

Making Modern Bible

King James Version alongside a Modern English Paraphrase

Protestant 66-Book Canon

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Genesis

Author: Moses, traditionally — the first of the five books he wrote under divine inspiration.

Date written: c. 1445–1405 BC, during or shortly after the forty years in the wilderness.

Written to: The nation of Israel, newly freed from Egypt and preparing to enter Canaan.

Setting: Before Israel existed as a nation — Genesis spans from the creation of the universe to the death of Joseph in Egypt, covering more time than all other Bible books combined.

Where this sits historically: Spans from creation through the death of Joseph (c. 1805 BC); the patriarchal era runs alongside Egypt's Middle Kingdom and the rise of the Mesopotamian city-states.

Contemporaries: The Sumerian and Akkadian civilizations of Abraham's day; the Hyksos and Egyptian Middle Kingdom during Joseph's lifetime. Job is traditionally placed in the patriarchal era.

Big themes:

- Creation — God made everything good; man was made in His image
- The Fall — sin entered through Adam, bringing death and separation from God
- The covenant — God chose Abraham and made unconditional promises about land, descendants, and blessing
- Providence — God works through human failure and evil to accomplish His purposes (Joseph's story)
- The seed — the promise of a coming deliverer runs from Genesis 3:15 through every generation

Key passages: Gen 1:1; 3:15; 12:1–3; 15:6; 50:20

How it fits: Genesis is the foundation of everything. Without the Fall there is no need for redemption; without the Abrahamic covenant there is no Israel, no Messiah, no church. Every major Bible doctrine — creation, sin, covenant, sacrifice, election — has its roots here. Exodus picks up the story four centuries later, when Abraham's descendants have become slaves.

Chapter 1

God created the heavens and the earth in six days — light, sky, land and vegetation, sun and moon and stars, sea creatures and birds, and land animals and man. He made man in his own image, male and female, and gave them dominion over every living thing.

■ **NAME NOTE** God (GOD) — "The LORD, the Creator" In Hebrew, "Elohim" here — the plural form used with singular verbs to denote majesty.

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | <i>In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.</i> | In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. |
| 2 | <i>And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.</i> | The earth was formless and empty, and darkness covered the face of the deep. The Spirit of God was moving over the surface of the waters. |
| 3 | <i>And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.</i> | God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light. |
| 4 | <i>And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness.</i> | God saw that the light was good. He separated the light from the darkness. |
| 5 | <i>And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.</i> | God called the light 'Day,' and the darkness He called 'Night.' And there was evening, and there was morning—the first day. |
| 6 | <i>And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.</i> | God said, 'Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters to separate the waters from the waters.' |
| 7 | <i>And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so.</i> | So God made the firmament and separated the waters under the firmament from the waters above it. And it was so. |
| 8 | <i>And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.</i> | God called the firmament 'Heaven.' And there was evening, and there was morning—the second day. |
| 9 | <i>And God said, Let the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry land appear: and it was so.</i> | God said, 'Let the waters under the heavens be gathered together into one place, and let the dry ground appear.' And it was so. |

- 10 *And God called the dry land Earth; and the gathering together of the waters called he Seas: and God saw that it was good.* God called the dry ground 'Earth,' and the gathered waters He called 'Seas.' And God saw that it was good.
- 11 *And God said, Let the earth bring forth grass, the herb yielding seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after his kind, whose seed is in itself, upon the earth: and it was so.* God said, 'Let the earth produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and fruit trees on the earth that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their kinds.' And it was so.
- 12 *And the earth brought forth grass, and herb yielding seed after his kind, and the tree yielding fruit, whose seed was in itself, after his kind: and God saw that it was good.* The earth produced vegetation: seed-bearing plants according to their kinds, and trees bearing fruit with seed in it according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good.
- 13 *And the evening and the morning were the third day.* There was evening, and there was morning—the third day.
- 14 *And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years:* God said, 'Let there be lights in the firmament of the heavens to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark sacred times, and days and years,
- 15 *And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so.* let them be lights in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth.' And it was so.
- 16 *And God made two great lights; the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night: he made the stars also.* God made two great lights—the greater light to govern the day and the lesser light to govern the night. He also made the stars.
- 17 *And God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth,* God set them in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth,

- 18 *And to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness: and God saw that it was good.* to govern the day and the night, and to separate light from darkness. And God saw that it was good.
- 19 *And the evening and the morning were the fourth day.* There was evening, and there was morning—the fourth day.
- 20 *And God said, Let the waters bring forth abundantly the moving creature that hath life, and fowl that may fly above the earth in the open firmament of heaven.* God said, 'Let the waters teem with living creatures, and let birds fly above the earth across the firmament of the heavens.'
- 21 *And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth abundantly, after their kind, and every winged fowl after his kind: and God saw that it was good.* So God created the great sea creatures and every living thing that moves, with which the waters teemed, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good.
- 22 *And God blessed them, saying, Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let fowl multiply in the earth.* God blessed them and said, 'Be fruitful and multiply and fill the waters in the seas, and let the birds multiply on the earth.'
- 23 *And the evening and the morning were the fifth day.* There was evening, and there was morning—the fifth day.
- 24 *And God said, Let the earth bring forth the living creature after his kind, cattle, and creeping thing, and beast of the earth after his kind: and it was so.* God said, 'Let the earth bring forth living creatures according to their kinds: livestock, creeping things, and wild animals of the earth according to their kinds.' And it was so.
- 25 *And God made the beast of the earth after his kind, and cattle after their kind, and every thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind: and God saw that it was good.* God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and every creeping thing of the ground according to its kind. And God saw that it was good.

- 26 *And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.* Then God said, 'Let us make man in our image, according to our likeness. Let them rule over the fish of the sea, the birds of the air, the livestock, all the earth, and every creeping thing that moves on the earth.'
- 27 *So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.* So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created Him; male and female He created them.
- 28 *And God blessed them, and God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.* God blessed them and said to them, 'Be fruitful and multiply; fill the earth and subdue it. Rule over the fish of the sea, the birds of the air, and every living thing that moves on the earth.'
- 29 *And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat.* Then God said, 'Look, I have given You every seed-bearing plant on the face of all the earth, and every tree that has fruit with seed in it. They shall be food for You.
- 30 *And to every beast of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to every thing that creepeth upon the earth, wherein there is life, I have given every green herb for meat: and it was so.* to every wild animal of the earth, every bird of the air, and every creature that moves on the earth—everything that has the breath of life—I have given every green plant for food.' And it was so.
- 31 *And God saw every thing that he had made, and, behold, it was very good. And the evening and the morning were the sixth day.* God saw everything He had made. It was very good indeed. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day.

Words in this chapter:

firmament — The expanse of sky — what God spread out above the earth on Day Two of creation to separate the waters.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1** — John 1:1-3; Heb 11:3; Isa 45:18; Rev 4:11; Heb 1:10
- v2** — Jer 4:23; Ps 104:30; Isa 45:18; Ps 33:6; Job 26:7
- v3** — 2 Cor 4:6; John 1:5; Isa 45:7; Isa 60:19; 1 John 1:5
- v4** — Eccl 2:13; Eccl 11:7; Gen 1:18; Gen 1:31; Gen 1:12
- v5** — Ps 74:16; Isa 45:7; Ps 104:20; 1 Thess 5:5; Gen 8:22
- v6** — Jer 51:15; Ps 33:6; Job 37:18; Job 26:7-8; Jer 10:12-13
- v14** — Ps 104:19-20; Deut 4:19; Ps 74:16-17; Jer 31:35; Ps 148:3
- v26** — Col 3:10; Eph 4:24; Ps 8:4-8; Gen 3:22; Gen 5:1
- v27** — Matt 19:4; Gen 5:1-2; Eph 2:10; Mark 10:6; Gen 2:21-25
- v28** — Gen 9:1; Gen 9:7; Lev 26:9; Ps 128:3-4; Gen 22:17-18
- v29** — Gen 9:3; Ps 104:14-15; Ps 145:15-16; Ps 104:27-28; Ps 147:9
- v31** — 1 Tim 4:4; Ps 104:24; Ps 19:1-2; Ex 20:11; Ps 104:31

Chapter 2

God rested on the seventh day and made it holy. He formed Adam from the dust, placed him in the garden of Eden, and commanded him not to eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. God made a woman from Adam's rib and brought her to him as a helper.

- | | | |
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| 1 | <i>Thus the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the host of them.</i> | So the heavens and the earth were completed, with all their vast array. |
| 2 | <i>And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had made.</i> | On the seventh day God finished the work He had been doing. He rested on the seventh day from all His work. |
| 3 | <i>And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because that in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.</i> | God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it He rested from all the work of creation that He had done. |

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| <p>4 <i>These are the generations of the heavens and of the earth when they were created, in the day that the LORD God made the earth and the heavens,</i></p> <p>5 <i>And every plant of the field before it was in the earth, and every herb of the field before it grew: for the LORD God had not caused it to rain upon the earth, and there was not a man to till the ground.</i></p> <p>6 <i>But there went up a mist from the earth, and watered the whole face of the ground.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.</i></p> | <p>These are the generations of the heavens and the earth when they were created, on the day that the LORD God made the earth and the heavens.</p> <p>No shrub of the field had yet appeared on the earth, and no plant of the field had yet sprung up, because the LORD God had not sent rain on the earth, and there was no man to work the ground.</p> <p>But a mist went up from the earth and watered the whole surface of the ground.</p> <p>Then the LORD God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living soul.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Eden (EE-den) — "Delight, pleasure" The garden God planted in the east where he placed Adam. Location of the tree of life.

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| <p>8 <i>And the LORD God planted a garden eastward in Eden; and there he put the man whom he had formed.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And out of the ground made the LORD God to grow every tree that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food; the tree of life also in the midst of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and evil.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And a river went out of Eden to water the garden; and from thence it was parted, and became into four heads.</i></p> | <p>The LORD God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, and there He placed the man he had formed.</p> <p>The LORD God made every tree grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.</p> <p>A river flowed out of Eden to water the garden, and from there it divided and became four headwaters.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Pison* (PIE-son) — "Increase, overflowing" *One of the four rivers flowing out of Eden; location is unknown. Havilah* (HAV-ih-lah) — "Circle, region" *A land rich in gold, surrounded by the Pison river.*

- 11 *The name of the first is Pison: that is it which compasseth the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold;* The name of the first is Pison; it winds through the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold.
- 12 *And the gold of that land is good: there is bdellium and the onyx stone.* The gold of that land is good; bdellium and onyx stone are also there.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Gihon* (GUY-hon) — "Bursting forth" *Second river of Eden, winding through Ethiopia (Cush). Ethiopia* (ee-thee-OH-pee-uh) — "Cush, burnt face" *Region south of Egypt; in Hebrew "Cush," named for Ham's son.*

- 13 *And the name of the second river is Gihon: the same is it that compasseth the whole land of Ethiopia.* The name of the second river is Gihon; it winds through the whole land of Ethiopia.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Hiddekel* (HID-eh-kel) — "Rapid, sharp voice" *Third river of Eden — the Tigris, running east of Assyria. Euphrates* (yoo-FRAY-teez) — "Fruitfulness, to break forth" *Fourth river of Eden. The great river that later formed the eastern border of the Promised Land.*

- 14 *And the name of the third river is Hiddekel: that is it which goeth toward the east of Assyria. And the fourth river is Euphrates.* The name of the third river is Hiddekel; it runs along the east side of Assyria. And the fourth river is the Euphrates.
- 15 *And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.* The LORD God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to work it and take care of it.
- 16 *And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat:* The LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden,
- 17 *But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.* but You must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for on the day You eat from it You will surely die.'

- 18 *And the LORD God said, It is not good that the man should be alone; I will make him an help meet for him.* Then the LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for Him.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Adam (AD-um) — "Man, from the ground (adamah)" The first man, formed from the dust of the earth in Eden.

- 19 *And out of the ground the LORD God formed every beast of the field, and every fowl of the air; and brought them unto Adam to see what he would call them: and whatsoever Adam called every living creature, that was the name thereof.* Out of the ground the LORD God formed every beast of the field and every bird of the air. He brought them to Adam to see what he would name them. And whatever Adam called each living creature, that was its name.
- 20 *And Adam gave names to all cattle, and to the fowl of the air, and to every beast of the field; but for Adam there was not found an help meet for him.* So Adam gave names to all the livestock, the birds of the air, and every wild animal. But for Adam no suitable helper was found.
- 21 *And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept: and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof;* So the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and while he slept he took one of his ribs and closed up the flesh in its place.
- 22 *And the rib, which the LORD God had taken from man, made he a woman, and brought her unto the man.* Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken from the man. He brought her to the man.
- 23 *And Adam said, This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh: she shall be called Woman, because she was taken out of Man.* Adam said, 'This at last is bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called Woman, because she was taken out of Man.'
- 24 *Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.* For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife. They shall become one flesh.
- 25 *And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed.* The man and his wife were both naked. They felt no shame.

Words in this chapter:

bdellium (*DEL-ee-um*) — A fragrant resin or precious stone mentioned in Genesis 2:12 and Numbers 11:7 — its exact identity is uncertain; likely a translucent gum-resin.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 31:17; Ex 20:11; Ps 33:6; Gen 1:1; Isa 45:18
- v2 — Heb 4:4; Ex 31:17; Deut 5:14; Ex 20:8-11; Ex 23:12
- v3 — Lev 23:3; Ezek 20:12; Mark 2:27; Ex 31:13-17; Luke 23:56
- v7 — Eccl 12:7; Job 33:4; 1 Cor 15:45; Isa 64:8; Acts 17:25
- v9 — Gen 3:22; Rev 2:7; Rev 22:14; Rev 22:2; Prov 11:30
- v15 — Ps 128:2; Gen 2:8; Eph 4:28; Gen 2:2
- v17 — Rom 6:23; Jas 1:15; Gen 3:19; 1 Cor 15:56; Gal 3:10
- v18 — Eccl 4:9-12; Prov 18:22; 1 Pet 3:7; 1 Cor 11:7-12; Ruth 3:1
- v22 — 1 Cor 11:8-9; 1 Tim 2:13; Heb 13:4; Prov 18:22; Prov 19:14
- v23 — Eph 5:28-30; 1 Cor 11:8-9; 2 Sam 5:1; Judg 9:2; Gen 29:14
- v24 — Matt 19:3-9; Eph 5:28-31; Mark 10:6-12; Rom 7:2; 1 Pet 3:1-7
- v25 — Gen 3:7; Gen 3:10-11; Rom 10:11; Joel 2:26; Jer 17:13

Chapter 3

The serpent deceived Eve into eating from the forbidden tree, and she gave the fruit to Adam, who also ate. God cursed the serpent, pronounced pain in childbearing for the woman and toil for the man, and drove them out of Eden, placing cherubim to guard the way to the tree of life.

- 1 *Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?* Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, you shall not eat from any tree in the garden?'
- 2 *And the woman said unto the serpent, We may eat of the fruit of the trees of the garden:* The woman said to the serpent, 'We may eat the fruit of the trees in the garden,

- 3 *But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God hath said, Ye shall not eat of it, neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die.* but God has said, You shall not eat the fruit of the tree in the middle of the garden, and you shall not touch it, or you will die.'
- 4 *And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:* the serpent said to the woman, 'You will not surely die.
- 5 *For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil.* For God knows that on the day you eat from it your eyes will be opened, and you will be like gods, knowing good and evil.'
- 6 *And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; and he did eat.* When the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasing to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took some of its fruit and ate it. She also gave some to her husband who was with her. He ate it.
- 7 *And the eyes of them both were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together, and made themselves aprons.* Then the eyes of both of them were opened. They realized they were naked. So they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves.
- 8 *And they heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day: and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God amongst the trees of the garden.* Then they heard the sound of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and Adam and his wife hid from the presence of the LORD God among the trees of the garden.
- 9 *And the LORD God called unto Adam, and said unto him, Where art thou?* But the LORD God called to Adam and said to him, 'Where are you?'
- 10 *And he said, I heard thy voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself.* He answered, 'I heard Your voice in the garden. I was afraid because I was naked, so I hid myself.'

- 11 *And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?* God said, 'Who told You that You were naked? Have You eaten from the tree that I commanded You not to eat from?'
- 12 *And the man said, The woman whom thou gavest to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I did eat.* The man said, 'The woman you gave to be with me—she gave me some of the fruit from the tree. I ate it.'
- 13 *And the LORD God said unto the woman, What is this that thou hast done? And the woman said, The serpent beguiled me, and I did eat.* Then the LORD God said to the woman, 'What is this you have done?' The woman said, 'The serpent deceived me. I ate.'
- 14 *And the LORD God said unto the serpent, Because thou hast done this, thou art cursed above all cattle, and above every beast of the field; upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat all the days of thy life:* So the LORD God said to the serpent, 'Because you have done this, you are cursed above all livestock and above every wild animal. On your belly you shall go, and dust you shall eat all the days of your life.'
- 15 *And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.* I will put hostility between you and the woman, and between your seed and hers; he shall bruise your head, and you shall bruise his heel.'
- 16 *Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children; and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee.* To the woman he said, 'I will greatly multiply your pain in childbearing; in pain you shall bring forth children. Your desire shall be for your husband. He shall rule over you.'
- 17 *And unto Adam he said, Because thou hast hearkened unto the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, of which I commanded thee, saying, Thou shalt not eat of it: cursed is the ground for thy sake; in sorrow shalt thou eat of it all the days of thy life;* to Adam he said, 'Because you listened to the voice of your wife and ate from the tree about which I commanded you, saying, You shall not eat from it—cursed is the ground because of you; in toil you shall eat from it all the days of your life.'

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| 18 <i>Thorns also and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herb of the field;</i> | It shall produce thorns and thistles for you, and you shall eat the plants of the field. |
| 19 <i>In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread, till thou return unto the ground; for out of it wast thou taken: for dust thou art, and unto dust shalt thou return.</i> | By the sweat of your face you shall eat bread, until you return to the ground, because from it you were taken. For dust you are, and to dust you shall return.' |

■ **NAME NOTE** Eve (EEV) — "Life-giver" Named by Adam in Genesis 3:20 as the mother of all living. The first woman.

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| 20 <i>And Adam called his wife's name Eve; because she was the mother of all living.</i> | Adam named his wife Eve, because she was the mother of all the living. |
| 21 <i>Unto Adam also and to his wife did the LORD God make coats of skins, and clothed them.</i> | The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife, and clothed them. |
| 22 <i>And the LORD God said, Behold, the man is become as one of us, to know good and evil: and now, lest he put forth his hand, and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live for ever:</i> | Then the LORD God said, 'Look, the man has become like one of us, knowing good and evil. Now, He must not be allowed to reach out His hand and take also from the tree of life and eat, and live forever.' |
| 23 <i>Therefore the LORD God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from whence he was taken.</i> | So the LORD God sent Him out of the garden of Eden to work the ground from which He had been taken. |
| 24 <i>So he drove out the man; and he placed at the east of the garden of Eden Cherubims, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to keep the way of the tree of life.</i> | He drove the man out, and on the east side of the garden of Eden he placed cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life. |

Words in this chapter:

cherubim (CHAIuh-bim) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four

faces and four wings.

Eve (EEV) — The first woman, made from Adam's rib — her name in Hebrew means 'living' or 'life-giver,' because she is the mother of all living.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 11:3; 2 Cor 11:14; Rev 12:9; Rev 20:2; Matt 4:3
- v5 — Ezek 28:2; 2 Thess 2:4; 2 Cor 11:13-15; Gen 2:17; 2 Cor 4:4
- v6 — 1 John 2:16; Jas 1:14-15; 1 Tim 2:14; 2 Sam 11:2; Josh 7:21
- v8 — Jer 23:24; Heb 4:13; Prov 15:3; Job 34:21-22; Ps 139:1-12
- v14 — Mic 7:17; Isa 65:25; Ps 72:9; Isa 29:4
- v15 — Rom 16:20; 1 John 3:8; Rev 12:17; Isa 7:14; Heb 2:14-15
- v16 — Titus 2:5; Col 3:18; 1 Cor 11:3; Eph 5:22-24; 1 Tim 2:15
- v17 — Rom 8:20-22; Gen 5:29; Isa 24:5-6; Eccl 2:22-23; John 16:33
- v19 — Eccl 12:7; Job 34:15; Ps 104:29; Gen 2:7; Ps 90:3
- v20 — Gen 2:23; Matt 1:23; Gen 2:20; Gen 5:29
- v21 — Isa 61:10; 2 Cor 5:21; 2 Cor 5:2-3; Gen 3:7
- v22 — Rev 2:7; Rev 22:14; Prov 3:18; Gen 11:6-7; Rev 22:2

Chapter 4

Cain and Abel brought offerings to the LORD; God accepted Abel's but rejected Cain's, and Cain killed his brother in the field. God cursed Cain to be a wanderer and marked him for protection, and Cain settled in the land of Nod. Adam and Eve had another son, Seth, and through his line men began to call on the name of the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE Cain (KAYN)** — "Acquired, gotten" Firstborn of Adam and Eve. Killed his brother Abel — first recorded murder.

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| 1 | <i>And Adam knew Eve his wife; and she conceived, and bare Cain, and said, I have gotten a man from the LORD.</i> | Adam was intimate with his wife Eve. She conceived and gave birth to Cain. She said, 'I have gotten a man from the LORD.' |
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■ **NAME NOTE Abel (AY-bul)** — "Breath, vapor" Second son of Adam and Eve. Offered the firstborn of his flock; killed by Cain.

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| 2 | <i>And she again bare his brother Abel. And Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.</i> | Later she gave birth to his brother Abel. Now Abel kept flocks, and Cain worked the soil. |
| 3 | <i>And in process of time it came to pass, that Cain brought of the fruit of the ground an offering unto the LORD.</i> | In the course of time, Cain brought some of the fruits of the soil as an offering to the LORD. |

- 4 *And Abel, he also brought of the firstlings of his flock and of the fat thereof. And the LORD had respect unto Abel and to his offering:* Abel also brought an offering—the firstborn of his flock and their fat. The LORD looked with favor on Abel and his offering,
- 5 *But unto Cain and to his offering he had not respect. And Cain was very wroth, and his countenance fell.* But on Cain and his offering he did not look with favor. So Cain was very angry. His face fell.
- 6 *And the LORD said unto Cain, Why art thou wroth? and why is thy countenance fallen?* Then the LORD said to Cain, 'Why are you angry, and why has your face fallen?
- 7 *If thou doest well, shalt thou not be accepted? and if thou doest not well, sin lieth at the door. And unto thee shall be his desire, and thou shalt rule over him.* If You do well, will You not be accepted? But if You do not do well, sin is crouching at the door; its desire is for You, but You must rule over it.'
- 8 *And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.* Cain spoke to his brother Abel, and while they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel and killed him.
- 9 *And the LORD said unto Cain, Where is Abel thy brother? And he said, I know not: Am I my brother's keeper?* Then the LORD said to Cain, 'Where is your brother Abel?' He said, 'I do not know. Am I my brother's keeper?'
- 10 *And he said, What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother's blood crieth unto me from the ground.* The LORD said, 'What have You done? The voice of Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.
- 11 *And now art thou cursed from the earth, which hath opened her mouth to receive thy brother's blood from thy hand;* Now You are cursed from the ground, which has opened its mouth to receive Your brother's blood from Your hand.
- 12 *When thou tillest the ground, it shall not henceforth yield unto thee her strength; a fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be in the earth.* When You work the ground, it shall no longer yield its strength to You. You shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth.'

- 13 *And Cain said unto the LORD, My punishment is greater than I can bear.* Cain said to the LORD, 'My punishment is greater than I can bear.
- 14 *Behold, thou hast driven me out this day from the face of the earth; and from thy face shall I be hid; and I shall be a fugitive and a vagabond in the earth; and it shall come to pass, that every one that findeth me shall slay me.* You have driven me out today from the face of the ground. I shall be hidden from Your face. I shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth, and whoever finds me will kill me.'
- 15 *And the LORD said unto him, Therefore whosoever slayeth Cain, vengeance shall be taken on him sevenfold. And the LORD set a mark upon Cain, lest any finding him should kill him.* The LORD said to Him, 'Therefore whoever kills Cain, he shall suffer vengeance sevenfold.' And the LORD put a mark on Cain, so that anyone who found him would not kill him.

■ **NAME NOTE** Nod (NOD) — "Wandering" Land east of Eden where Cain dwelt after his exile.

- 16 *And Cain went out from the presence of the LORD, and dwelt in the land of Nod, on the east of Eden.* Then Cain went out from the presence of the LORD and lived in the land of Nod, east of Eden.

■ **NAME NOTE** Enoch (EE-nock) — "Dedicated" Two Enochs appear. First is Cain's son, namesake of the first city. Second is the righteous man in Genesis 5 who "walked with God" and was taken without dying.

- 17 *And Cain knew his wife; and she conceived, and bare Enoch: and he builded a city, and called the name of the city, after the name of his son, Enoch.* Cain was intimate with his wife. She conceived and gave birth to Enoch. Then Cain built a city and named it Enoch, after his son.

■ **NAME NOTE** Irad (EYE-rad) — "Fugitive, wild donkey" Son of Enoch (Cain's line). Mehujael (meh-HOO-jay-el) — "Smitten of God" Descendant of Cain. Methusael (meh-THOO-sa-el) — "Man of God" Descendant of Cain. Not to be confused with Methuselah of Seth's line. Lamech (LAY-mek) — "Powerful" Two Lamechs: one in Cain's line (Genesis 4, violent boaster), one in Seth's line (Genesis 5, father of Noah).

- 18 *And unto Enoch was born Irad: and Irad begat Mehujael: and Mehujael begat Methusael: and Methusael begat Lamech.* To Enoch was born Irad, and Irad begat Mehujael, and Mehujael begat Methusael, and Methusael begat Lamech.

■ **NAME NOTE** Adah (AY-dah) — "Ornament" One of Lamech's two wives (Cain's line). First mention of polygamy in the Bible. Zillah (ZIL-ah) — "Shadow" Lamech's second wife.

- 19 *And Lamech took unto him two wives: the name of the one was Adah, and the name of the other Zillah.* Lamech took two wives: the name of one was Adah, and the name of the other was Zillah.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jabal (JAY-bal) — "Stream, flowing" Father of nomadic herdsmen (tent-dwellers with livestock).

- 20 *And Adah bare Jabal: he was the father of such as dwell in tents, and of such as have cattle.* Adah gave birth to Jabal; he was the father of those who live in tents and raise livestock.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jubal (JOO-bal) — "Ram's horn, stream" Father of all musicians — the harp and flute.

- 21 *And his brother's name was Jubal: he was the father of all such as handle the harp and organ.* His brother's name was Jubal; he was the father of all who play the harp and flute.

■ **NAME NOTE** Tubalcain (TOO-bal-KANE) — "Worker in iron/bronze" First recorded metalworker. Forged tools of bronze and iron. Naamah (NAY-a-mah) — "Pleasant" Sister of Tubal-cain.

- 22 *And Zillah, she also bare Tubalcain, an instructor of every artificer in brass and iron: and the sister of Tubalcain was Naamah.* Zillah also gave birth to Tubal-cain, who forged all kinds of tools out of bronze and iron. Tubal-cain's sister was Naamah.
- 23 *And Lamech said unto his wives, Adah and Zillah, Hear my voice; ye wives of Lamech, hearken unto my speech: for I have slain a man to my wounding, and a young man to my hurt.* Lamech said to his wives, 'Adah and Zillah, hear my voice; wives of Lamech, listen to my words. I have killed a man for wounding me, a young man for injuring me.
- 24 *If Cain shall be avenged sevenfold, truly Lamech seventy and sevenfold.* If Cain is avenged sevenfold, then Lamech seventy-sevenfold.'

■ **NAME NOTE** *Seth (SETH) — "Appointed, granted" Third son of Adam and Eve, appointed in place of Abel. Ancestor of Noah and eventually Christ.*

25 <i>And Adam knew his wife again; and she bare a son, and called his name Seth: For God, said she, hath appointed me another seed instead of Abel, whom Cain slew.</i>	Adam was intimate with his wife again. She gave birth to a son and named him Seth, saying, 'God has granted me another child in place of Abel, since Cain killed him.'
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Enos (EE-noss) — "Mortal man" Seth's son. In his time "men began to call upon the name of the LORD."*

26 <i>And to Seth, to him also there was born a son; and he called his name Enos: then began men to call upon the name of the LORD.</i>	To Seth also a son was born. He named Him Enosh. At that time people began to call on the name of the LORD.
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Words in this chapter:

- countenance** — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.
- Abel** (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.
- Cain** (*KAYN*) — Adam and Eve's firstborn son — he killed his brother Abel and was sent away under God's curse to wander the earth.
- Enoch** (*EE-nok*) — A man who 'walked with God' — he did not die but was taken by God; ancestor of Noah; father of Methuselah.
- Seth** (*SETH*) — Adam's third son, born after Abel's death — the line of Seth continued to Noah; his name means 'appointed' or 'granted.'

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 John 3:12; 1 John 3:15
- v4** — Heb 11:4; Prov 3:9; Ex 13:12; Num 18:17; 1 Pet 1:19-20
- v5** — Heb 11:4; Job 5:2
- v6** — Isa 1:18; Job 5:2
- v7** — Jas 1:15; Rom 2:6-10; Isa 3:10-11; Rom 6:16; Heb 11:4
- v8** — Matt 23:35; 1 John 3:12-15; Jude 1:11; Prov 26:24-26; Luke 11:51
- v9** — Prov 28:13; John 8:44
- v10** — Heb 12:24; Ps 72:14; Heb 11:4; Isa 5:7; Jas 5:4
- v14** — Num 35:19; Job 15:20-24; Ps 143:7
- v15** — Ezek 9:4; Ps 79:12; Gen 4:24; Ezek 9:6

v24 — Matt 18:22; Gen 4:15

v26 — Ps 116:17; 1 Kgs 18:24; Joel 2:32; Zeph 3:9; Gen 12:8

Chapter 5

The descendants of Adam are listed from Seth to Noah, recording each patriarch's age at the birth of his firstborn and at death. Enoch walked with God and was taken — he did not die. Noah was born to Lamech, and Noah begat Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

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| 1 | <i>This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, in the likeness of God made he him;</i> | This is the book of the generations of Adam. On the day that God created man, He made Him in the likeness of God. |
| 2 | <i>Male and female created he them; and blessed them, and called their name Adam, in the day when they were created.</i> | Male and female he created them. He blessed them and named them 'Man' on the day they were created. |
| 3 | <i>And Adam lived an hundred and thirty years, and begat a son in his own likeness, after his image; and called his name Seth:</i> | Adam lived 130 years, and begat a son in his own likeness, after his image, and named him Seth. |
| 4 | <i>And the days of Adam after he had begotten Seth were eight hundred years: and he begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Seth, Adam lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 5 | <i>And all the days that Adam lived were nine hundred and thirty years: and he died.</i> | All the days that Adam lived were 930 years, and then he died. |
| 6 | <i>And Seth lived an hundred and five years, and begat Enos:</i> | Seth lived 105 years and begat Enosh. |
| 7 | <i>And Seth lived after he begat Enos eight hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Enosh, Seth lived 807 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 8 | <i>And all the days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years: and he died.</i> | All the days of Seth were 912 years, and then he died. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Cainan (KAY-nan) — "Possession, smith" Son of Enos in the line from Seth.*

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| 9 | <i>And Enos lived ninety years, and begat Cainan:</i> | Enosh lived 90 years and begat Cainan. |
| 10 | <i>And Enos lived after he begat Cainan eight hundred and fifteen years, and begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Cainan, Enosh lived 815 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 11 | <i>And all the days of Enos were nine hundred and five years: and he died.</i> | All the days of Enosh were 905 years, and then he died. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Mahalaleel (ma-HAL-a-LEEL) — "Praise of God" Son of Cainan in Seth's line.*

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| 12 | <i>And Cainan lived seventy years, and begat Mahalaleel:</i> | Cainan lived 70 years and begat Mahalaleel. |
| 13 | <i>And Cainan lived after he begat Mahalaleel eight hundred and forty years, and begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Mahalaleel, Cainan lived 840 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 14 | <i>And all the days of Cainan were nine hundred and ten years: and he died.</i> | All the days of Cainan were 910 years, and then he died. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Jared (JAIR-ed) — "Descent" Father of Enoch (the righteous one).*

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| 15 | <i>And Mahalaleel lived sixty and five years, and begat Jared:</i> | Mahalaleel lived 65 years and begat Jared. |
| 16 | <i>And Mahalaleel lived after he begat Jared eight hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Jared, Mahalaleel lived 830 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 17 | <i>And all the days of Mahalaleel were eight hundred ninety and five years: and he died.</i> | All the days of Mahalaleel were 895 years, and then he died. |
| 18 | <i>And Jared lived an hundred sixty and two years, and he begat Enoch:</i> | Jared lived 162 years and begat Enoch. |
| 19 | <i>And Jared lived after he begat Enoch eight hundred years, and begat sons and daughters:</i> | After he begat Enoch, Jared lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters. |

- 20 *And all the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty and two years: and he died.* All the days of Jared were 962 years, and then he died.

■ **NAME NOTE** Methuselah (meh-THOO-zuh-lah) — "Man of the dart, or "when he dies, it shall be sent"" Longest-lived man in the Bible: 969 years. Son of Enoch, grandfather of Noah. Died the year of the Flood.

- 21 *And Enoch lived sixty and five years, and begat Methuselah:* Enoch lived 65 years and begat Methuselah.
- 22 *And Enoch walked with God after he begat Methuselah three hundred years, and begat sons and daughters:* After he begat Methuselah, Enoch walked with God 300 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 23 *And all the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty and five years:* All the days of Enoch were 365 years.
- 24 *And Enoch walked with God: and he was not; for God took him.* Enoch walked with God, and then He was no more, because God took him.
- 25 *And Methuselah lived an hundred eighty and seven years, and begat Lamech:* Methuselah lived 187 years and begat Lamech.
- 26 *And Methuselah lived after he begat Lamech seven hundred eighty and two years, and begat sons and daughters:* After he begat Lamech, Methuselah lived 782 years and had other sons and daughters.
- 27 *And all the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty and nine years: and he died.* All the days of Methuselah were 969 years, and then he died.
- 28 *And Lamech lived an hundred eighty and two years, and begat a son:* Lamech lived 182 years and begat a son.

■ **NAME NOTE** Noah (NO-uh) — "Rest, comfort" Tenth from Adam through Seth. Righteous man preserved through the Flood in the ark.

- 29 *And he called his name Noah, saying, This same shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands, because of the ground which the LORD hath cursed.* He named Him Noah and said, 'This one shall comfort us from our work and the toil of our hands, because of the ground the LORD has cursed.'

- 30 *And Lamech lived after he begat Noah* After he begat Noah, Lamech lived
five hundred ninety and five years, 595 years and had other sons and
and begat sons and daughters: daughters.
- 31 *And all the days of Lamech were* All the days of Lamech were 777
seven hundred seventy and seven years, and then he died.
years: and he died.

■ **NAME NOTE** Shem (*SHEM*) — "Name, renown" Noah's son. Ancestor of the Semitic peoples, including Abraham. Ham (*HAM*) — "Hot, burnt" Noah's son. Father of Canaan; ancestor of the peoples of Africa and the Canaanites. Japheth (*JAY-feth*) — "Enlargement, opened wide" Noah's son. Ancestor of many of the coastland and northern peoples.

- 32 *And Noah was five hundred years old:* Noah was 500 years old, and Noah
and Noah begat Shem, Ham, and begat Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
Japheth.

Words in this chapter:

Ham (*HAM*) — Noah's second son — ancestor of the Canaanites and African peoples; cursed through his son Canaan for dishonoring Noah.

Japheth (*JAY-feth*) — Noah's third son — ancestor of the Indo-European peoples; his name means 'enlargement.'

Methuselah (*meh-THYOO-zeh-lah*) — The oldest person in the Bible, living 969 years — son of Enoch, grandfather of Noah; his name may mean 'his death shall bring judgment.'

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Shem (*SHEM*) — Noah's eldest son — ancestor of the Semitic peoples including the Israelites; his name means 'name' or 'fame.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Eph 4:24; Col 3:10; Gen 1:26-27; Heb 1:3; Eccl 12:1

v2 — Mark 10:6; Matt 19:4; Gen 2:23; Mal 2:15; Gen 1:27

v3 — Gen 4:25

v4 — 1 Chr 1:1-3

v5 — Gen 5:8; Gen 5:11; Gen 3:19; 2 Sam 14:14

v22 — 1 Thess 2:12; Gen 17:1; Mal 2:6; Luke 1:6; Gen 6:9

v24 — Heb 11:5-6; 1 John 1:7; Gen 5:22; Luke 23:43; 2 Kgs 2:11

v29 — Matt 24:37; Heb 11:7; 2 Pet 2:5

Chapter 6

The sons of God took the daughters of men as wives, and wickedness filled the earth until every thought of man's heart was only evil. God resolved to destroy all flesh by a flood but found favor in Noah, who was righteous. He commanded Noah to build an ark and bring his family and two of every living creature aboard.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, when men began to multiply on the face of the earth, and daughters were born unto them,</i> | When men began to multiply on the face of the earth and daughters were born to them, |
| 2 | <i>That the sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were fair; and they took them wives of all which they chose.</i> | The sons of God saw that the daughters of men were beautiful. They took as wives any of them they chose. |
| 3 | <i>And the LORD said, My spirit shall not always strive with man, for that he also is flesh: yet his days shall be an hundred and twenty years.</i> | Then the LORD said, 'My Spirit shall not always strive with man, for He also is flesh; yet His days shall be 120 years.' |
| 4 | <i>There were giants in the earth in those days; and also after that, when the sons of God came in unto the daughters of men, and they bare children to them, the same became mighty men which were of old, men of renown.</i> | There were giants on the earth in those days—and also afterward—when the sons of God went to the daughters of men and had children by them. These were the mighty men of old, men of renown. |
| 5 | <i>And GOD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually.</i> | GOD saw that the wickedness of man was great on the earth, and that every intention of the thoughts of His heart was only evil continually. |
| 6 | <i>And it repented the LORD that he had made man on the earth, and it grieved him at his heart.</i> | The LORD repented that He had made man on the earth. It grieved Him to His heart. |
| 7 | <i>And the LORD said, I will destroy man whom I have created from the face of the earth; both man, and beast, and the creeping thing, and the fowls of the air; for it repenteth me that I have made them.</i> | So the LORD said, 'I will blot out man whom I have created from the face of the earth—both man and beast, creeping things, and birds of the air—for I regret that I have made them.' |

- 8 *But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.* But Noah found favor in the eyes of the LORD.
- 9 *These are the generations of Noah: Noah was a just man and perfect in his generations, and Noah walked with God.* These are the generations of Noah. Noah was a righteous man, blameless in his generations; Noah walked with God.
- 10 *And Noah begat three sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth.* Noah begat three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
- 11 *The earth also was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence.* Now the earth was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence.
- 12 *And God looked upon the earth, and, behold, it was corrupt; for all flesh had corrupted his way upon the earth.* God looked upon the earth. It was corrupt, for all flesh had corrupted their way on the earth.
- 13 *And God said unto Noah, The end of all flesh is come before me; for the earth is filled with violence through them; and, behold, I will destroy them with the earth.* God said to Noah, 'The end of all flesh has come before me, for the earth is filled with violence because of them. I will destroy them along with the earth.
- 14 *Make thee an ark of gopher wood; rooms shalt thou make in the ark, and shalt pitch it within and without with pitch.* Make yourself an ark of gopher wood. Make rooms in the ark, and cover it inside and out with pitch.
- 15 *And this is the fashion which thou shalt make it of: The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits, the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits.* This is how you shall make it: The length of the ark shall be 300 cubits, its width 50 cubits, and its height 30 cubits.
- 16 *A window shalt thou make to the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish it above; and the door of the ark shalt thou set in the side thereof; with lower, second, and third stories shalt thou make it.* Make a window for the ark, finished a cubit from the top. Set the door of the ark in its side, and make it with lower, second, and third decks.

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| <p>17 <i>And, behold, I, even I, do bring a flood of waters upon the earth, to destroy all flesh, wherein is the breath of life, from under heaven; and every thing that is in the earth shall die.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But with thee will I establish my covenant; and thou shalt come into the ark, thou, and thy sons, and thy wife, and thy sons' wives with thee.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And of every living thing of all flesh, two of every sort shalt thou bring into the ark, to keep them alive with thee; they shall be male and female.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Of fowls after their kind, and of cattle after their kind, of every creeping thing of the earth after his kind, two of every sort shall come unto thee, to keep them alive.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And take thou unto thee of all food that is eaten, and thou shalt gather it to thee; and it shall be for food for thee, and for them.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Thus did Noah; according to all that God commanded him, so did he.</i></p> | <p>I myself am bringing a flood of waters upon the earth to destroy all flesh under heaven in which is the breath of life. Everything on the earth shall die.</p> <p>But I will establish my covenant with you, and you shall come into the ark—you, your sons, your wife, and your sons' wives with you.</p> <p>Of every living thing of all flesh, you shall bring two of every kind into the ark to keep them alive with you; they shall be male and female.</p> <p>Of the birds according to their kinds, of the livestock according to their kinds, and of every creeping thing of the ground according to its kind—two of each kind shall come to you to keep them alive.</p> <p>Also take with you every kind of food that is eaten, and gather it to yourself; it shall be food for you and for them.'</p> <p>Noah did all this; according to all that God had commanded him, so He did.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ham (*HAM*) — Noah's second son — ancestor of the Canaanites and African peoples; cursed through his son Canaan for dishonoring Noah.

Japheth (*JAY-feth*) — Noah's third son — ancestor of the Indo-European peoples; his name means 'enlargement.'

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Shem (*SHEM*) — Noah's eldest son — ancestor of the Semitic peoples including the Israelites; his name means 'name' or 'fame.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 82:6-7; 1 John 2:16; 2 Pet 2:14; Rom 9:7-8; Deut 7:3-4
- v3 — Neh 9:30; Isa 63:10; Jer 11:11; 1 Pet 3:18-20; Ps 78:39
- v4 — Num 13:33; 2 Sam 21:15-22; 1 Sam 17:4; Deut 3:11; Deut 2:20-21
- v5 — Matt 15:19; Rom 1:28-31; Mark 7:21-23; Jer 4:14; Jer 17:9
- v6 — Isa 63:10; 1 Sam 15:11; Eph 4:30; 1 Sam 15:29; Heb 3:10
- v8 — Gen 19:19; Heb 4:16; Ps 84:11; Luke 1:30; Ps 145:20
- v9 — Heb 11:7; Luke 1:6; Gal 3:11; 2 Pet 2:5; Gen 5:24
- v11 — Ezek 8:17; Hos 4:1-2; Hab 2:8; Rom 3:19; Rom 2:13
- v12 — Ps 53:2-3; Prov 15:3; Ps 14:1-3
- v13 — Hos 4:1-2; 1 Pet 4:7; Ezek 7:2-6; Gen 6:11-12; 2 Pet 3:10-12
- v17 — Gen 7:4; 2 Pet 2:5; Gen 7:21-23; Ps 107:34; 1 Pet 3:20
- v22 — John 15:14; Ex 40:16; John 2:5; Matt 7:24-27; Gen 7:5

Chapter 7

The LORD told Noah to enter the ark with his household and the animals, and after seven days the flood came. The fountains of the deep burst open and rain fell for forty days and forty nights, covering even the highest mountains. Every living thing on land died; only Noah and those with him in the ark survived.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD said unto Noah, Come thou and all thy house into the ark; for thee have I seen righteous before me in this generation.</i> | Then the LORD said to Noah, 'Come into the ark, you and all your household, for I have seen that you are righteous before me in this generation. |
| 2 | <i>Of every clean beast thou shalt take to thee by sevens, the male and his female: and of beasts that are not clean by two, the male and his female.</i> | Of every clean animal You shall take with You seven pairs, the male and His female, and of the animals that are not clean, two, the male and His female. |
| 3 | <i>Of fowls also of the air by sevens, the male and the female; to keep seed alive upon the face of all the earth.</i> | Also of the birds of the air, seven pairs, male and female, to keep seed alive on the face of all the earth. |
| 4 | <i>For yet seven days, and I will cause it to rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights; and every living substance that I have made will I destroy from off the face of the earth.</i> | For in seven days I will send rain on the earth for forty days and forty nights, and every living thing I have made I will blot out from the face of the ground.' |
| 5 | <i>And Noah did according unto all that the LORD commanded him.</i> | Noah did all that the LORD had commanded Him. |

- 6 *And Noah was six hundred years old when the flood of waters was upon the earth.* Noah was 600 years old when the floodwaters came upon the earth.
- 7 *And Noah went in, and his sons, and his wife, and his sons' wives with him, into the ark, because of the waters of the flood.* Noah and his sons and his wife and his sons' wives with him went into the ark because of the waters of the flood.
- 8 *Of clean beasts, and of beasts that are not clean, and of fowls, and of every thing that creepeth upon the earth,* Of clean animals, and of animals that are not clean, and of birds, and of everything that creeps on the ground,
- 9 *There went in two and two unto Noah into the ark, the male and the female, as God had commanded Noah.* Two and two, male and female, went into the ark with Noah, as God had commanded Noah.
- 10 *And it came to pass after seven days, that the waters of the flood were upon the earth.* After seven days, the waters of the flood came upon the earth.
- 11 *In the six hundredth year of Noah's life, in the second month, the seventeenth day of the month, the same day were all the fountains of the great deep broken up, and the windows of heaven were opened.* In the 600th year of Noah's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month—on that very day all the fountains of the great deep burst forth, and the windows of heaven were opened.
- 12 *And the rain was upon the earth forty days and forty nights.* The rain fell on the earth forty days and forty nights.
- 13 *In the selfsame day entered Noah, and Shem, and Ham, and Japheth, the sons of Noah, and Noah's wife, and the three wives of his sons with them, into the ark;* On that very day Noah entered the ark, along with Shem, Ham, and Japheth, Noah's sons, and Noah's wife and the three wives of his sons,

- 14 *They, and every beast after his kind, and all the cattle after their kind, and every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind, and every fowl after his kind, every bird of every sort.* They and every wild animal according to its kind, all the livestock according to their kinds, every creeping thing that creeps on the earth according to its kind, and every bird according to its kind—every bird of every sort.
- 15 *And they went in unto Noah into the ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein is the breath of life.* They went in to Noah into the ark, two by two of all flesh in which was the breath of life.
- 16 *And they that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded him: and the LORD shut him in.* Those that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded Him. The LORD shut Him in.
- 17 *And the flood was forty days upon the earth; and the waters increased, and bare up the ark, and it was lift up above the earth.* The flood was on the earth forty days, and the waters increased and lifted up the ark. It rose above the earth.
- 18 *And the waters prevailed, and were increased greatly upon the earth; and the ark went upon the face of the waters.* The waters prevailed and increased greatly upon the earth, and the ark floated on the surface of the waters.
- 19 *And the waters prevailed exceedingly upon the earth; and all the high hills, that were under the whole heaven, were covered.* The waters prevailed so mightily on the earth that all the high mountains under the whole heaven were covered.
- 20 *Fifteen cubits upward did the waters prevail; and the mountains were covered.* The waters prevailed above the mountains, covering them fifteen cubits deep.
- 21 *And all flesh died that moved upon the earth, both of fowl, and of cattle, and of beast, and of every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth, and every man:* All flesh that moved on the earth died—birds, livestock, wild animals, all the creeping things that creep on the earth, and every man.

22	<i>All in whose nostrils was the breath of life, of all that was in the dry land, died.</i>	Everything on dry land in whose nostrils was the breath of life died.
23	<i>And every living substance was destroyed which was upon the face of the ground, both man, and cattle, and the creeping things, and the fowl of the heaven; and they were destroyed from the earth: and Noah only remained alive, and they that were with him in the ark.</i>	He blotted out every living thing that was on the face of the ground—man and animals and creeping things and birds of the air; they were blotted out from the earth. Only Noah was left, and those who were with him in the ark.
24	<i>And the waters prevailed upon the earth an hundred and fifty days.</i>	The waters prevailed upon the earth 150 days.

Words in this chapter:

- Ham** (*HAM*) — Noah's second son — ancestor of the Canaanites and African peoples; cursed through his son Canaan for dishonoring Noah.
- Japheth** (*JAY-feth*) — Noah's third son — ancestor of the Indo-European peoples; his name means 'enlargement.'
- Noah** (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'
- Shem** (*SHEM*) — Noah's eldest son — ancestor of the Semitic peoples including the Israelites; his name means 'name' or 'fame.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 24:37-39; 2 Pet 2:5-9; Gen 6:9; Heb 11:7; Isa 3:10-11
- v2** — Gen 8:20; Lev 10:10; Lev 11:1-47
- v4** — Gen 7:17; Gen 7:12; Gen 6:13; Gen 6:17; Gen 6:7
- v5** — Gen 6:22; Luke 8:21
- v7** — Luke 17:27
- v11** — Gen 8:2; Mal 3:10; Prov 8:28-29; Amos 9:5-6
- v16** — Matt 25:10; Luke 13:25; Ps 91:1-10; Gen 7:2-3
- v17** — Gen 7:4
- v21** — Gen 6:13
- v22** — Gen 2:7
- v23** — 2 Pet 2:5; 1 Pet 3:20; Heb 11:7; Luke 17:26-27

Chapter 8

God sent a wind over the earth and the floodwaters receded; the ark came to rest on the mountains of Ararat. Noah sent out a raven and then a dove to test whether the ground was dry, and when the dove did not return he knew the waters had subsided. God told Noah to leave the ark, and Noah built an altar and offered burnt offerings; the LORD vowed never again to curse the ground or destroy every living thing.

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| 1 | <i>And God remembered Noah, and every living thing, and all the cattle that was with him in the ark: and God made a wind to pass over the earth, and the waters asswaged;</i> | But God remembered Noah and all the wild animals and all the livestock that were with him in the ark. God sent a wind over the earth, and the waters subsided. |
| 2 | <i>The fountains also of the deep and the windows of heaven were stopped, and the rain from heaven was restrained;</i> | The fountains of the deep and the windows of heaven were closed, and the rain from heaven was restrained. |
| 3 | <i>And the waters returned from off the earth continually: and after the end of the hundred and fifty days the waters were abated.</i> | The waters receded from the earth continually, and at the end of 150 days the waters had abated. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Ararat (AIR-uh-rat) — "Sacred land, high ground" Mountain range in modern eastern Turkey / Armenia where Noah's ark came to rest.

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| 4 | <i>And the ark rested in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat.</i> | In the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, the ark came to rest on the mountains of Ararat. |
| 5 | <i>And the waters decreased continually until the tenth month: in the tenth month, on the first day of the month, were the tops of the mountains seen.</i> | The waters continued to decrease until the tenth month. In the tenth month, on the first day of the month, the tops of the mountains became visible. |
| 6 | <i>And it came to pass at the end of forty days, that Noah opened the window of the ark which he had made:</i> | At the end of forty days, Noah opened the window of the ark he had made. |
| 7 | <i>And he sent forth a raven, which went forth to and fro, until the waters were dried up from off the earth.</i> | He sent out a raven, which kept going back and forth until the waters had dried up from the earth. |

- 8 *Also he sent forth a dove from him, to see if the waters were abated from off the face of the ground;* Then he sent out a dove from him to see if the waters had subsided from the face of the ground.
- 9 *But the dove found no rest for the sole of her foot, and she returned unto him into the ark, for the waters were on the face of the whole earth: then he put forth his hand, and took her, and pulled her in unto him into the ark.* But the dove found no resting place for the sole of her foot. She returned to him in the ark, for the waters were on the surface of the whole earth. So he put out his hand and took her and brought her into the ark with him.
- 10 *And he stayed yet other seven days; and again he sent forth the dove out of the ark;* He waited another seven days, and again he sent the dove out of the ark.
- 11 *And the dove came in to him in the evening; and, lo, in her mouth was an olive leaf pluckt off: so Noah knew that the waters were abated from off the earth.* The dove came back to him in the evening, and in her mouth was a freshly plucked olive leaf. So Noah knew that the waters had subsided from the earth.
- 12 *And he stayed yet other seven days; and sent forth the dove; which returned not again unto him any more.* Then he waited another seven days and sent out the dove. But she did not return to him anymore.
- 13 *And it came to pass in the six hundredth and first year, in the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were dried up from off the earth: and Noah removed the covering of the ark, and looked, and, behold, the face of the ground was dry.* In Noah's 601st year, in the first month, on the first day of the month, the waters were dried up from the earth. Noah removed the covering of the ark and looked, and the surface of the ground was dry.
- 14 *And in the second month, on the seven and twentieth day of the month, was the earth dried.* In the second month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month, the earth was dry.
- 15 *And God spake unto Noah, saying,* Then God spoke to Noah, saying,

- 16 *Go forth of the ark, thou, and thy wife, and thy sons, and thy sons' wives with thee.* 'Go out of the ark, you and your wife and your sons and your sons' wives with you.
- 17 *Bring forth with thee every living thing that is with thee, of all flesh, both of fowl, and of cattle, and of every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth; that they may breed abundantly in the earth, and be fruitful, and multiply upon the earth.* Bring out with you every living thing that is with you of all flesh—birds, livestock, and every creeping thing that creeps on the earth—so that they may swarm on the earth and be fruitful and multiply on the earth.'
- 18 *And Noah went forth, and his sons, and his wife, and his sons' wives with him:* So Noah went out, and his sons and his wife and his sons' wives with him.
- 19 *Every beast, every creeping thing, and every fowl, and whatsoever creepeth upon the earth, after their kinds, went forth out of the ark.* Every animal, every creeping thing, and every bird—everything that moves on the earth—went out of the ark by families.
- 20 *And Noah builded an altar unto the LORD; and took of every clean beast, and of every clean fowl, and offered burnt offerings on the altar.* Then Noah built an altar to the LORD, and took some of every clean animal and of every clean bird, and offered burnt offerings on the altar.
- 21 *And the LORD smelled a sweet savour; and the LORD said in his heart, I will not again curse the ground any more for man's sake; for the imagination of man's heart is evil from his youth; neither will I again smite any more every thing living, as I have done.* The LORD smelled a sweet savour. The LORD said in His heart, 'I will never again curse the ground because of man, for the intention of man's heart is evil from His youth. Neither will I ever again strike down every living thing as I have done.'
- 22 *While the earth remaineth, seedtime and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease.* While the earth remains, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night shall not cease.'

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 30:22; Gen 19:29; Ps 136:23; Ex 2:24; 1 Sam 1:19

v2 — Gen 7:11; Matt 8:26-27

v9 — Ps 116:7; Matt 11:28; John 16:33; Deut 28:65

v16 — Gen 7:13

v17 — Gen 1:22

v20 — Heb 13:15-16; Gen 22:9; Rom 12:1; Gen 12:7-8; 1 Pet 2:9

v21 — 2 Cor 2:15; Eph 5:2; Gen 6:5; Jer 17:9; Phil 4:18

v22 — Jas 5:7; Ps 74:16-17; Jer 5:24; Jer 31:35; Song 2:11-12

Chapter 9

God blessed Noah and his sons, permitted them to eat meat but forbade eating blood, and established the rainbow as the sign of his covenant never to destroy the earth by flood again. Noah planted a vineyard, became drunk, and lay uncovered in his tent; Ham saw his nakedness, but Shem and Japheth covered him. When Noah awoke he cursed Canaan and blessed Shem and Japheth.

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| <p>¹ <i>And God blessed Noah and his sons, and said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth.</i></p> | <p>God blessed Noah and his sons and said to them, 'Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And the fear of you and the dread of you shall be upon every beast of the earth, and upon every fowl of the air, upon all that moveth upon the earth, and upon all the fishes of the sea; into your hand are they delivered.</i></p> | <p>The fear of you and the dread of you shall be upon every beast of the earth, upon every bird of the air, upon everything that creeps on the ground, and upon all the fish of the sea. They are delivered into your hand.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>Every moving thing that liveth shall be meat for you; even as the green herb have I given you all things.</i></p> | <p>Every moving thing that lives shall be food for you. As I gave you the green plants, so now I give you everything.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.</i></p> | <p>But you shall not eat flesh with its life, that is, its blood.</p> |

- 5 *And surely your blood of your lives will I require; at the hand of every beast will I require it, and at the hand of man; at the hand of every man's brother will I require the life of man.* For your lifeblood I will surely demand a reckoning. From every animal I will demand it, and from every man I will demand it—from every man's brother I will demand the life of man.
- 6 *Whoso sheddeth man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed: for in the image of God made he man.* Whoever sheds man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed, for in the image of God He made man.
- 7 *And you, be ye fruitful, and multiply; bring forth abundantly in the earth, and multiply therein.* As for you, be fruitful and multiply; bring forth abundantly on the earth and multiply in it.'
- 8 *And God spake unto Noah, and to his sons with him, saying,* Then God said to Noah and to his sons with him,
- 9 *And I, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you;* 'I establish my covenant with you and with your seed after you,
- 10 *And with every living creature that is with you, of the fowl, of the cattle, and of every beast of the earth with you; from all that go out of the ark, to every beast of the earth.* With every living creature that is with you—the birds, the livestock, and every beast of the earth with you—all who came out of the ark, every beast of the earth.
- 11 *And I will establish my covenant with you; neither shall all flesh be cut off any more by the waters of a flood; neither shall there any more be a flood to destroy the earth.* I establish my covenant with you: never again shall all flesh be cut off by the waters of a flood, and never again shall there be a flood to destroy the earth.'
- 12 *And God said, This is the token of the covenant which I make between me and you and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations:* God said, 'This is the sign of the covenant I am making between me and you and every living creature with you, for all future generations:
- 13 *I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth.* I have set my bow in the clouds. It shall be a sign of the covenant between me and the earth.

- 14 *And it shall come to pass, when I bring a cloud over the earth, that the bow shall be seen in the cloud:* Whenever I bring clouds over the earth and the bow appears in the clouds,
- 15 *And I will remember my covenant, which is between me and you and every living creature of all flesh; and the waters shall no more become a flood to destroy all flesh.* I will remember my covenant between me and you and every living creature of all flesh, and the waters shall never again become a flood to destroy all flesh.
- 16 *And the bow shall be in the cloud; and I will look upon it, that I may remember the everlasting covenant between God and every living creature of all flesh that is upon the earth.* The bow shall be in the clouds. I will see it and remember the everlasting covenant between God and every living creature of all flesh that is on the earth.'
- 17 *And God said unto Noah, This is the token of the covenant, which I have established between me and all flesh that is upon the earth.* God said to Noah, 'This is the sign of the covenant I have established between me and all flesh on the earth.'
- 18 *And the sons of Noah, that went forth of the ark, were Shem, and Ham, and Japheth: and Ham is the father of Canaan.* The sons of Noah who went out of the ark were Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Ham was the father of Canaan.
- 19 *These are the three sons of Noah: and of them was the whole earth overspread.* These three were the sons of Noah, and from them the people of the whole earth were dispersed.
- 20 *And Noah began to be an husbandman, and he planted a vineyard:* Noah began to be a farmer. He planted a vineyard.
- 21 *And he drank of the wine, and was drunken; and he was uncovered within his tent.* He drank of the wine and became drunk. He lay uncovered in his tent.
- 22 *And Ham, the father of Canaan, saw the nakedness of his father, and told his two brethren without.* Ham, the father of Canaan, saw the nakedness of his father and told his two brothers outside.

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| <p>23 <i>And Shem and Japheth took a garment, and laid it upon both their shoulders, and went backward, and covered the nakedness of their father; and their faces were backward, and they saw not their father's nakedness.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And Noah awoke from his wine, and knew what his younger son had done unto him.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And he said, Cursed be Canaan; a servant of servants shall he be unto his brethren.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Shem; and Canaan shall be his servant.</i></p> <p>27 <i>God shall enlarge Japheth, and he shall dwell in the tents of Shem; and Canaan shall be his servant.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And Noah lived after the flood three hundred and fifty years.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And all the days of Noah were nine hundred and fifty years: and he died.</i></p> | <p>Then Shem and Japheth took a garment, laid it on both their shoulders, and walked backward and covered the nakedness of their father. Their faces were turned away. They did not see their father's nakedness.</p> <p>When Noah awoke from his wine and knew what his youngest son had done to him,</p> <p>He said, 'Cursed be Canaan; a servant of servants shall he be to his brothers.'</p> <p>He also He said, 'Blessed be the LORD, the God of Shem, and let Canaan be his servant.</p> <p>May God enlarge Japheth, and let him dwell in the tents of Shem, and let Canaan be his servant.'</p> <p>After the flood Noah lived 350 years.</p> <p>All the days of Noah were 950 years, and then he died.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 1:28; Gen 9:7; Gen 8:17
v2 — Ps 8:4-8; Gen 1:28; Jas 3:7; Hos 2:18; Ezek 34:25
v3 — Rom 14:14; 1 Tim 4:3-5; Deut 12:15; Col 2:21-22; 1 Cor 10:31
v4 — Deut 12:23; Deut 15:23; Deut 12:16; Acts 15:20; Lev 7:26
v5 — Ex 21:28-29; Ex 21:12; Gen 4:9-10
v6 — Lev 24:17; Matt 26:52; Rev 13:10; Num 35:33; Ex 21:12-14
v11 — Isa 54:9; Gen 8:21-22; 2 Pet 3:7
v13 — Ezek 1:28; Rev 10:1; Rev 4:3

v15 — Deut 7:9; Ezek 16:60; Isa 54:8-10; Ex 28:12; Ps 106:45
v16 — Jer 32:40; Isa 54:8-10; Gen 17:19; Gen 17:13; 2 Sam 23:5
v21 — Prov 20:1; Hab 2:15-16; Prov 23:31-32; Titus 2:2; Gal 5:21
v25 — Deut 27:16; Josh 9:23; Judg 1:28-30; Josh 9:27; 1 Kgs 9:20-21

Chapter 10

The descendants of Noah's three sons — Japheth, Ham, and Shem — are listed as the nations that spread across the earth after the flood. Nimrod, a descendant of Ham, became the first mighty man and empire-builder, founding Babel and Nineveh. From these clans the nations divided into their territories, each with its own language.

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| 1 | <i>Now these are the generations of the sons of Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth: and unto them were sons born after the flood.</i> | Now these are the generations of the sons of Noah: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Sons were born to them after the flood. |
| 2 | <i>The sons of Japheth; Gomer, and Magog, and Madai, and Javan, and Tubal, and Meshech, and Tiras.</i> | The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras. |
| 3 | <i>And the sons of Gomer; Ashkenaz, and Riphath, and Togarmah.</i> | The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Riphath, and Togarmah. |
| 4 | <i>And the sons of Javan; Elishah, and Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim.</i> | The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim. |
| 5 | <i>By these were the isles of the Gentiles divided in their lands; every one after his tongue, after their families, in their nations.</i> | From these the coastland peoples spread into their territories, each with its own language, by their clans, in their nations. |
| 6 | <i>And the sons of Ham; Cush, and Mizraim, and Phut, and Canaan.</i> | The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Phut, and Canaan. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Sheba (SHEE-bah) — "Oath, seven" Grandson of Keturah. Multiple Shebas in Scripture — including the famous Queen of Sheba later. Dedan (DEE-dan) — "Low country" Arab tribe of northwest Arabia.

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| 7 | <i>And the sons of Cush; Seba, and Havilah, and Sabtah, and Raamah, and Sabtecha: and the sons of Raamah; Sheba, and Dedan.</i> | The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabtah, Raamah, and Sabteca. The sons of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Nimrod (NIM-rod) — "Rebel, we shall rebel" "Mighty hunter before the LORD." First empire-builder; founded Babel, Nineveh, and other cities.

- 8 *And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be a mighty one in the earth.* Cush begat Nimrod; He was the first on earth to be a mighty man.
- 9 *He was a mighty hunter before the LORD: wherefore it is said, Even as Nimrod the mighty hunter before the LORD.* He was a mighty hunter before the LORD; therefore it is said, 'Like Nimrod, a mighty hunter before the LORD.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Babel (BAY-bul) — "Confusion (Hebrew) / Gate of God (Akkadian)" The city and tower where God confused human language. Later known as Babylon. Erech (EE-rek) — "Length" Ancient Mesopotamian city (modern Uruk), part of Nimrod's kingdom. Accad (AK-kad) — "Fortress" City in Nimrod's kingdom; namesake of the Akkadian Empire. Calneh (KAL-neh) — "Fortress of Anu" Fourth city of Nimrod's kingdom in Shinar. Shinar (SHY-nar) — "Country of two rivers" The plain of Mesopotamia (between Tigris and Euphrates) where Babel was built.

- 10 *And the beginning of his kingdom was Babel, and Erech, and Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar.* The beginning of His kingdom was Babel, Erech, Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar.

■ **NAME NOTE** Asshur (ASH-er) — "A step, successful" Son of Shem; namesake of Assyria. Nineveh (NIN-eh-vah) — "Dwelling of Ninus, or fish-town" Great Assyrian city. Later the city God sent Jonah to warn. Rehoboth (reh-HO-both) — "Wide places, streets" City built by Asshur (Rehoboth-Ir) near Nineveh. Calah (KAY-lah) — "Completion, vigor" Ancient Assyrian city (modern Nimrud).

- 11 *Out of that land went forth Asshur, and buidled Nineveh, and the city Rehoboth, and Calah,* From that land He went to Assyria and built Nineveh, Rehoboth-Ir, Calah,

■ **NAME NOTE** Resen (REE-sen) — "Bridle, bit" City between Nineveh and Calah; described as "a great city."

- 12 *And Resen between Nineveh and Calah: the same is a great city.* Resen between Nineveh and Calah—that is the great city.
- 13 *And Mizraim begat Ludim, and Ananim, and Lehabim, and Naphtuhim,* Mizraim begat the Ludim, Ananim, Lehabim, Naphtuhim,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Philistim* (fil-IS-tim) — "Wanderers, immigrants" *The Philistines. Descendants of Casluhim. Inhabited the southern coastal plain of Canaan. Caphtorim* (KAF-tor-im) — "People of Caphtor (Crete)" *Seafaring people related to the Philistines.*

- 14 *And Pathrusim, and Casluhim, (out of whom came Philistim,) and Caphtorim.* Pathrusim, Casluhim (from whom the Philistines came), and Caphtorim.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Heth* (HETH) — "Terror" *Ham's grandson; ancestor of the Hittites. Abraham negotiated with the sons of Heth for Sarah's burial plot.*

- 15 *And Canaan begat Sidon his firstborn, and Heth,* Canaan begat Sidon His firstborn, and Heth,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Jebusite* (JEB-yoo-site) — "Descendant of Jebus" *Canaanite tribe inhabiting what would become Jerusalem until David's conquest. Amorite* (AM-or-ite) — "Westerner, mountain dweller" *One of the main Canaanite peoples. Some were allies of Abraham. Girgasite* (GUR-guh-site) — "Clay-dweller" *Canaanite tribe.*

- 16 *And the Jebusite, and the Amorite, and the Girgasite,* The Jebusites, the Amorites, the Girgasite,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Hivite* (HIVE-ite) — "Villager" *Canaanite tribe.*

- 17 *And the Hivite, and the Arkite, and the Sinite,* The Hivites, the Arkites, the Sinites,
- 18 *And the Arvadite, and the Zemarite, and the Hamathite: and afterward were the families of the Canaanites spread abroad.* The Arvadites, the Zemarites, and the Hamathites. Afterward the families of the Canaanites spread abroad.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Sodom* (SOD-um) — "Burning, scorched" *City of the plain destroyed by fire for its wickedness. Gomorrah* (guh-MOR-uh) — "Ruin, submersion" *Sister city of Sodom; destroyed with it. Admah* (AD-mah) — "Red earth" *Third of the cities of the plain, destroyed with Sodom. Zeboiim* (zeh-BOY-im) — "Gazelles" *Fourth of the cities of the plain. Lasha* (LAY-shah) — "Fissure" *Eastern boundary of the Canaanites. Gerar* (GEE-rar) — "Lodging place, circle" *Philistine city in southern Canaan where Abraham and later Isaac sojourned.*

- 19 *And the border of the Canaanites was from Sidon, as thou comest to Gerar, unto Gaza; as thou goest, unto Sodom, and Gomorrah, and Admah, and Zeboim, even unto Lasha.* The territory of the Canaanites extended from Sidon in the direction of Gerar as far as Gaza, and in the direction of Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboim, as far as Lasha.
- 20 *These are the sons of Ham, after their families, after their tongues, in their countries, and in their nations.* These are the sons of Ham, by their clans, by their languages, in their lands, in their nations.

■ **NAME NOTE** Eber (EE-bur) — "The other side, crossing over" Great-grandson of Shem. The name "Hebrew" derives from him.

- 21 *Unto Shem also, the father of all the children of Eber, the brother of Japheth the elder, even to him were children born.* To Shem also, the father of all the children of Eber, the older brother of Japheth, children were born.

■ **NAME NOTE** Arphaxad (ar-FACKS-ad) — "Uncertain — possibly "healer" or "boundary of the Chaldees"" Son of Shem, father of Salah. In the line to Abraham. Elam (EE-lam) — "Eternity, hidden" Region east of Babylon (modern southwest Iran); Chedorlaomer was its king.

- 22 *The children of Shem; Elam, and Asshur, and Arphaxad, and Lud, and Aram.* The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, and Aram.
- 23 *And the children of Aram; Uz, and Hul, and Gether, and Mash.* The sons of Aram: Uz, Hul, Gether, and Mash.

■ **NAME NOTE** Salah (SAY-lah) — "Sprout, sending forth" Son of Arphaxad in Shem's line.

- 24 *And Arphaxad begat Salah; and Salah begat Eber.* Arphaxad begat Salah, and Salah begat Eber.

■ **NAME NOTE** Peleg (PEE-leg) — "Division" "In his days was the earth divided" — likely referring to the scattering at Babel. Joktan (JOCK-tan) — "Small" Peleg's brother; ancestor of several Arabian tribes.

- 25 *And unto Eber were born two sons: the name of one was Peleg; for in his days was the earth divided; and his brother's name was Joktan.* To Eber were born two sons: the name of one was Peleg, for in his days the earth was divided. His brother's name was Joktan.

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| 26 | <i>And Joktan begat Almodad, and Sheleph, and Hazarmaveth, and Jerah,</i> | Joktan begat Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, |
| 27 | <i>And Hadoram, and Uzal, and Diklah,</i> | Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, |
| 28 | <i>And Obal, and Abimael, and Sheba,</i> | Obal, Abimael, Sheba, |
| 29 | <i>And Ophir, and Havilah, and Jobab: all these were the sons of Joktan.</i> | Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab; all these were the sons of Joktan. |
| 30 | <i>And their dwelling was from Mesha, as thou goest unto Sephar a mount of the east.</i> | Their dwelling place extended from Mesha in the direction of Sephar, the hill country of the east. |
| 31 | <i>These are the sons of Shem, after their families, after their tongues, in their lands, after their nations.</i> | These are the sons of Shem, by their clans, by their languages, in their lands, by their nations. |
| 32 | <i>These are the families of the sons of Noah, after their generations, in their nations: and by these were the nations divided in the earth after the flood.</i> | These are the clans of the sons of Noah, according to their generations, in their nations, and from these the nations spread abroad on the earth after the flood. |

Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steenyz*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Gomorraah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 38:2; Ezek 38:6

v5 — Zeph 2:11

v10 — Gen 11:9; Gen 11:2

v14 — Jer 47:4

v23 — Job 1:1

v25 — 1 Chr 1:19; Gen 10:32; Deut 32:8; Luke 3:35-36; Acts 17:26

v32 — Gen 9:19; Acts 17:26

Chapter 11

The whole earth shared one language, and the people built a city and tower at Babel to make a name for themselves; the LORD confused their language and scattered them across the earth. The descendants of Shem are listed from Arphaxad to Abram. Terah took his son Abram, Abram's wife Sarai, and his grandson Lot from Ur of the Chaldees toward Canaan, but they settled in Haran, where Terah died.

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| 1 | <i>And the whole earth was of one language, and of one speech.</i> | Now the whole earth had one language and one speech. |
| 2 | <i>And it came to pass, as they journeyed from the east, that they found a plain in the land of Shinar; and they dwelt there.</i> | As people journeyed from the east, they found a plain in the land of Shinar and settled there. |
| 3 | <i>And they said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and burn them thoroughly. And they had brick for stone, and slime had they for mortar.</i> | They said to one another, 'Come, let us make bricks and bake them thoroughly.' They used brick for stone and tar for mortar. |
| 4 | <i>And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.</i> | Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city and a tower with its top in the heavens, and let us make a name for ourselves, lest we be scattered across the face of the whole earth.' |
| 5 | <i>And the LORD came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of men builded.</i> | But the LORD came down to see the city and the tower which the sons of men had built. |

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| 6 <i>And the LORD said, Behold, the people is one, and they have all one language; and this they begin to do: and now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do.</i> | The LORD said, ' The people are one. They all have one language, and this is only the beginning of what they will do. Now nothing they plan to do will be withheld from them. |
| 7 <i>Go to, let us go down, and there confound their language, that they may not understand one another's speech.</i> | Come, let us go down and confuse their language there, so that they will not understand one another's speech.' |
| 8 <i>So the LORD scattered them abroad from thence upon the face of all the earth: and they left off to build the city.</i> | So the LORD scattered them from there over the face of all the earth. They stopped building the city. |
| 9 <i>Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because the LORD did there confound the language of all the earth: and from thence did the LORD scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.</i> | Therefore its name was called Babel, because there the LORD confused the language of all the earth. From there the LORD scattered them over the face of all the earth. |
| 10 <i>These are the generations of Shem: Shem was an hundred years old, and begat Arphaxad two years after the flood:</i> | These are the generations of Shem. Shem was 100 years old and begat Arphaxad two years after the flood. |
| 11 <i>And Shem lived after he begat Arphaxad five hundred years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Arphaxad, Shem lived 500 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 12 <i>And Arphaxad lived five and thirty years, and begat Salah:</i> | Arphaxad lived 35 years and begat Salah. |
| 13 <i>And Arphaxad lived after he begat Salah four hundred and three years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Salah, Arphaxad lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 14 <i>And Salah lived thirty years, and begat Eber:</i> | Salah lived 30 years and begat Eber. |

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| 15 <i>And Salah lived after he begat Eber four hundred and three years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Eber, Salah lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters. |
| 16 <i>And Eber lived four and thirty years, and begat Peleg:</i> | Eber lived 34 years and begat Peleg. |
| 17 <i>And Eber lived after he begat Peleg four hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Peleg, Eber lived 430 years and had other sons and daughters. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Reu (ROO)* — "Friend" Son of Peleg.

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| 18 <i>And Peleg lived thirty years, and begat Reu:</i> | Peleg lived 30 years and begat Reu. |
| 19 <i>And Peleg lived after he begat Reu two hundred and nine years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Reu, Peleg lived 209 years and had other sons and daughters. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Serug (SAIR-oog)* — "Branch, intertwined" Great-grandfather of Abraham.

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| 20 <i>And Reu lived two and thirty years, and begat Serug:</i> | Reu lived 32 years and begat Serug. |
| 21 <i>And Reu lived after he begat Serug two hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Serug, Reu lived 207 years and had other sons and daughters. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Nahor (NAY-hor)* — "Snorting, snoring" Two Nahors: Abraham's grandfather and Abraham's brother. The brother stayed in Mesopotamia and was grandfather of Rebekah.

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| 22 <i>And Serug lived thirty years, and begat Nahor:</i> | Serug lived 30 years and begat Nahor. |
| 23 <i>And Serug lived after he begat Nahor two hundred years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Nahor, Serug lived 200 years and had other sons and daughters. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Terah (TEE-rah)* — "Station, wanderer" Father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran. Led his family from Ur toward Canaan but stopped at Haran, where he died.

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| 24 <i>And Nahor lived nine and twenty years, and begat Terah:</i> | Nahor lived 29 years and begat Terah. |
| 25 <i>And Nahor lived after he begat Terah an hundred and nineteen years, and begat sons and daughters.</i> | After he begat Terah, Nahor lived 119 years and had other sons and daughters. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Abram (AY-bram) — "Exalted father" Original name of Abraham. Called by God from Ur at age 75. Haran (HAIR-an) — "Mountaineer, parched" Abram's brother and father of Lot; also the name of the city where Terah settled.

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| 26 <i>And Terah lived seventy years, and begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran.</i> | Terah lived 70 years and begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Lot (LOT) — "Covering, veil" Abraham's nephew. Settled in Sodom; was rescued before its destruction.

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| 27 <i>Now these are the generations of Terah: Terah begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran; and Haran begat Lot.</i> | Now these are the generations of Terah. Terah begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran. Haran begat Lot. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Ur (UR) — "Flame, light" Ur of the Chaldees — Abraham's birthplace, an advanced Sumerian city in southern Mesopotamia.

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| 28 <i>And Haran died before his father Terah in the land of his nativity, in Ur of the Chaldees.</i> | Haran died during the lifetime of his father Terah in his native land, in Ur of the Chaldees. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Sarai (SAIR-eye) — "My princess" Abram's wife. Renamed Sarah in Genesis 17. Milcah (MIL-kah) — "Queen" Nahor's wife; grandmother of Rebekah. Iscah (IS-kah) — "Watchful" Daughter of Haran; some rabbinic traditions identify her with Sarah.

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| 29 <i>And Abram and Nahor took them wives: the name of Abram's wife was Sarai; and the name of Nahor's wife, Milcah, the daughter of Haran, the father of Milcah, and the father of Iscah.</i> | Abram and Nahor took wives. The name of Abram's wife was Sarai, and the name of Nahor's wife was Milcah, the daughter of Haran, who was the father of Milcah and Iscah. |
| 30 <i>But Sarai was barren; she had no child.</i> | But Sarai was barren; she had no child. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Canaan (KAY-nan) — "Lowland, merchant" The Promised Land, named for Ham's son. Stretched from the Jordan to the Mediterranean.*

- 31 *And Terah took Abram his son, and Lot the son of Haran his son's son, and Sarai his daughter in law, his son Abram's wife; and they went forth with them from Ur of the Chaldees, to go into the land of Canaan; and they came unto Haran, and dwelt there.* Terah took his son Abram, his grandson Lot son of Haran, and his daughter-in-law Sarai the wife of his son Abram, and they set out together from Ur of the Chaldees to go to the land of Canaan. They came to Haran and settled there.
- 32 *And the days of Terah were two hundred and five years: and Terah died in Haran.* The days of Terah were 205 years, and Terah died in Haran.

Words in this chapter:

Abram (*AY-bram*) — The original name of Abraham, meaning 'exalted father' — God later changed it to Abraham when He gave the covenant of circumcision.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Sarai (*SAIR-eye*) — Abraham's wife's original name, meaning 'my princess' — God changed it to Sarah ('princess of many') when He promised she would bear Isaac.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Ur (*ER*) — The city in Mesopotamia where Abraham was born — a sophisticated Sumerian city on the Euphrates River in modern Iraq; God called Abraham to leave it for Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Acts 2:6; Zeph 3:9

v2 — Dan 1:2; Gen 10:10; Gen 14:1

v3 — Gen 14:10; Ex 1:14; Ex 2:3; Heb 10:24; Jas 5:1

v4 — Deut 1:28; John 5:44; Luke 1:51; Dan 4:30; Deut 9:1

v5 — Ps 33:13-14; Gen 18:21; John 3:13; Jer 23:23-24; Heb 4:13

v6 — Ps 2:1-4; Gen 3:22; Gen 11:1; Luke 1:51; Eccl 11:9

v7 — Ps 33:10; Job 5:12-13; Ps 55:9; Gen 1:26

v8 — Luke 1:51; Gen 10:32; Gen 10:25; Deut 32:8

v9 — Gen 10:10; Gen 10:5; Gen 10:20; Acts 17:26; 1 Cor 14:23

v26 — Josh 24:2

v29 — Gen 17:15; Gen 22:20

v31 — Neh 9:7; Acts 7:2-4; Gen 12:4; Gen 24:10; Gen 15:7

Chapter 12

The LORD called Abram to leave his country and go to a land he would show him, promising to make him a great nation. Abram obeyed, traveled through Canaan, and built altars at Shechem and Bethel. A famine drove him to Egypt, where he told Sarai to say she was his sister; Pharaoh took her into his house but was struck with plagues and sent them away.

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| 1 | <i>Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house, unto a land that I will shew thee:</i> | Now the LORD had said to Abram, 'Leave your country, your relatives, and your father's house, and go to the land I will show you. |
| 2 | <i>And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing:</i> | I will make You into a great nation. I will bless You and make Your name great, and You will be a blessing. |
| 3 | <i>And I will bless them that bless thee, and curse him that curseth thee: and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.</i> | I will bless those who bless You, and curse the one who curses you. In you all the families of the earth shall be blessed.' |
| 4 | <i>So Abram departed, as the LORD had spoken unto him; and Lot went with him: and Abram was seventy and five years old when he departed out of Haran.</i> | So Abram went, as the LORD had told Him, and Lot went with him. Abram was 75 years old when he left Haran. |
| 5 | <i>And Abram took Sarai his wife, and Lot his brother's son, and all their substance that they had gathered, and the souls that they had gotten in Haran; and they went forth to go into the land of Canaan; and into the land of Canaan they came.</i> | Abram took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, all their possessions they had gathered, and the people they had acquired in Haran. They set out for the land of Canaan. When they came to the land of Canaan, |

■ **NAME NOTE** Sichem (SHY-kem) — "Shoulder, ridge" Later spelled Shechem. Central hill country town where Abram first built an altar in Canaan. Moreh (MOR-eh) — "Teacher, early rain" The plain (or oak) of Moreh near Shechem. Canaanite (KAY-nan-ite) — "Lowlander, merchant" General term for the peoples inhabiting Canaan before Israel's conquest.

- 6 *And Abram passed through the land unto the place of Sichem, unto the plain of Moreh. And the Canaanite was then in the land.* Abram passed through the land to the place of Shechem, to the oak of Moreh. At that time the Canaanites were in the land.
- 7 *And the LORD appeared unto Abram, and said, Unto thy seed will I give this land: and there builded he an altar unto the LORD, who appeared unto him.* Then the LORD appeared to Abram and said, 'To your seed I will give this land.' So He built there an altar to the LORD, Who had appeared to Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** Bethel (BETH-el) — "House of God" Town where Abram built an altar. Later, Jacob's ladder vision would take place here. Hai (HI) — "Ruin, heap" Later spelled Ai. East of Bethel; later destroyed by Joshua.

- 8 *And he removed from thence unto a mountain on the east of Bethel, and pitched his tent, having Bethel on the west, and Hai on the east: and there he builded an altar unto the LORD, and called upon the name of the LORD.* From there He moved to the mountain east of Bethel and pitched his tent, with Bethel on the west and Ai on the east. There He built an altar to the LORD and called on the name of the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE** Negev (NEH-gev) — "South, dry country" The southern desert region of Canaan ("the south" in KJV).

- 9 *And Abram journeyed, going on still toward the south.* Then Abram continued his journey, going on toward the south.

■ **NAME NOTE** Egypt (EE-jipt) — "Black land, or land of Mizraim" The great civilization of the Nile. Abraham sought refuge here during famine.

- 10 *And there was a famine in the land: and Abram went down into Egypt to sojourn there; for the famine was grievous in the land.* Now there was a famine in the land, and Abram went down to Egypt to stay there, for the famine was severe in the land.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when he was come near to enter into Egypt, that he said unto Sarai his wife, Behold now, I know that thou art a fair woman to look upon:* As he was about to enter Egypt, he said to his wife Sarai, 'Look, I know that you are a beautiful woman.

12 *Therefore it shall come to pass, when the Egyptians shall see thee, that they shall say, This is his wife: and they will kill me, but they will save thee alive.* When the Egyptians see you, they will say, This is his wife. They will kill me but let you live.

13 *Say, I pray thee, thou art my sister: that it may be well with me for thy sake; and my soul shall live because of thee.* Please say you are my sister, so that it will go well with me for your sake, and my life will be spared because of you.'

■ **NAME NOTE** *Egyptian (ee-JIP-shun) — "Person of Egypt" People of Egypt, descended from Ham through Mizraim.*

14 *And it came to pass, that, when Abram was come into Egypt, the Egyptians beheld the woman that she was very fair.* When Abram entered Egypt, the Egyptians saw that the woman was very beautiful.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Pharaoh (FAIR-oh) — "Great house" Title for the king of Egypt, not a personal name. Multiple Pharaohs appear in Scripture.*

15 *The princes also of Pharaoh saw her, and commended her before Pharaoh: and the woman was taken into Pharaoh's house.* Pharaoh's officials saw her and praised her to Pharaoh, and the woman was taken into Pharaoh's house.

16 *And he entreated Abram well for her sake: and he had sheep, and oxen, and he asses, and menservants, and maidservants, and she asses, and camels.* He treated Abram well for her sake, and Abram acquired sheep, oxen, male donkeys, male and female servants, female donkeys, and camels.

17 *And the LORD plagued Pharaoh and his house with great plagues because of Sarai Abram's wife.* But the LORD struck Pharaoh and his house with great plagues because of Sarai, Abram's wife.

18 *And Pharaoh called Abram, and said, What is this that thou hast done unto me? why didst thou not tell me that she was thy wife?* So Pharaoh summoned Abram and said, 'What is this you have done to me? Why did you not tell me that she was your wife?

- 19 *Why saidst thou, She is my sister? so I might have taken her to me to wife: now therefore behold thy wife, take her, and go thy way.* Why did you say, She is my sister, so that I took her for my wife? Now then, here is your wife. Take her and go.'
- 20 *And Pharaoh commanded his men concerning him: and they sent him away, and his wife, and all that he had.* Pharaoh gave orders to his men concerning him. They sent him away with his wife and all that he had.

Words in this chapter:

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Abram (*AY-bram*) — The original name of Abraham, meaning 'exalted father' — God later changed it to Abraham when He gave the covenant of circumcision.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Sarai (*SAIR-eye*) — Abraham's wife's original name, meaning 'my princess' — God changed it to Sarah ('princess of many') when He promised she would bear Isaac.

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Heb 11:8; Acts 7:2-6; Neh 9:7; Isa 51:2; Josh 24:2-3
- v2** — 2 Sam 7:9; Gal 3:14; Gen 18:18; Gen 17:4-6; Gen 28:3-4
- v3** — Gal 3:8; Gen 22:18; Acts 3:25-26; Gen 27:29; Num 24:9
- v4** — Heb 11:8; Gen 11:31
- v5** — Gen 14:14
- v6** — Heb 11:9; Deut 11:30
- v7** — Gen 17:8; Gen 13:15; Gen 17:1; Gal 3:16; Gen 18:1
- v8** — Gen 4:26; Neh 11:31
- v12** — Gen 20:11; Gen 26:7
- v13** — Gen 26:7; Gen 20:2; Gen 20:12-13
- v16** — Gen 20:14
- v17** — 1 Chr 16:21; Gen 20:18

Chapter 13

Abram returned from Egypt to Canaan, wealthy in livestock, silver, and gold, but strife arose between his herdsmen and Lot's because the land could not support them both. Abram let Lot choose first; Lot chose the well-watered plain of the Jordan and settled near Sodom. The LORD promised Abram all the land he could see and seed as numerous as the dust of the earth, and Abram settled by the oaks of Mamre in Hebron.

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| <p>1 <i>And Abram went up out of Egypt, he, and his wife, and all that he had, and Lot with him, into the south.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And Abram was very rich in cattle, in silver, and in gold.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And he went on his journeys from the south even to Bethel, unto the place where his tent had been at the beginning, between Bethel and Hai;</i></p> <p>4 <i>Unto the place of the altar, which he had made there at the first: and there Abram called on the name of the LORD.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And Lot also, which went with Abram, had flocks, and herds, and tents.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And the land was not able to bear them, that they might dwell together: for their substance was great, so that they could not dwell together.</i></p> | <p>So Abram went up from Egypt, he and his wife and all that he had, and Lot with him, into the south.</p> <p>Now Abram was very rich in livestock, in silver, and in gold.</p> <p>He journeyed on by stages from the south as far as Bethel, to the place where his tent had been at the beginning, between Bethel and Ai,</p> <p>To the place of the altar that He had made there at first. And there Abram called on the name of the LORD.</p> <p>Lot, who went with Abram, also had flocks and herds and tents.</p> <p>The land could not support them dwelling together, for their possessions were so great that they could not remain together.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Perizzite (PER-iz-ite) — "Villager, unwallled" Canaanite people inhabiting the hill country.

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| <p>7 <i>And there was a strife between the herdmen of Abram's cattle and the herdmen of Lot's cattle: and the Canaanite and the Perizzite dwelled then in the land.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Abram said unto Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen; for we be brethren.</i></p> | <p>There was strife between the herdsmen of Abram's livestock and the herdsmen of Lot's livestock. At that time the Canaanites and the Perizzites were dwelling in the land.</p> <p>So Abram said to Lot, 'Please, let there be no strife between you and me, and between my herdsmen and your herdsmen, for we are brothers.</p> |
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- 9 *Is not the whole land before thee? separate thyself, I pray thee, from me: if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right; or if thou depart to the right hand, then I will go to the left.* Is not the whole land before you? Please separate yourself from me. If you take the left, then I will go to the right; or if you take the right, then I will go to the left.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Zoar (ZO-ar) — "Smallness, insignificance" Fifth city of the plain, spared at Lot's request and where he fled during Sodom's destruction. Jordan (JOR-dan) — "Descender" The great river of Palestine, flowing from the north down to the Dead Sea.

- 10 *And Lot lifted up his eyes, and beheld all the plain of Jordan, that it was well watered every where, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, even as the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as thou comest unto Zoar.* Lot lifted up his eyes and saw that the whole plain of the Jordan was well watered everywhere—before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah—like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as You go toward Zoar.
- 11 *Then Lot chose him all the plain of Jordan; and Lot journeyed east: and they separated themselves the one from the other.* So Lot chose for himself the whole plain of the Jordan, and Lot journeyed east. Thus they separated from each other.
- 12 *Abram dwelled in the land of Canaan, and Lot dwelled in the cities of the plain, and pitched his tent toward Sodom.* Abram lived in the land of Canaan, while Lot lived among the cities of the plain and pitched his tent near Sodom.
- 13 *But the men of Sodom were wicked and sinners before the LORD exceedingly.* Now the men of Sodom were wicked, great sinners against the LORD.
- 14 *And the LORD said unto Abram, after that Lot was separated from him, Lift up now thine eyes, and look from the place where thou art northward, and southward, and eastward, and westward:* The LORD said to Abram, after Lot had separated from him, 'Now lift up your eyes and look from the place where you are, northward, southward, eastward, and westward.

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| <p>15 <i>For all the land which thou seest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed for ever.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And I will make thy seed as the dust of the earth: so that if a man can number the dust of the earth, then shall thy seed also be numbered.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Arise, walk through the land in the length of it and in the breadth of it; for I will give it unto thee.</i></p> | <p>For all the land which You see, I will give to You and to Your seed forever.</p> <p>I will make Your seed as the dust of the earth, so that if anyone could count the dust of the earth, then your seed could also be counted.</p> <p>Arise, walk through the land in its length and its breadth, for I will give it to You.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Mamre (MAM-reh) — "Strength, vigor" An Amorite ally of Abraham; also the plain/oaks near Hebron where Abraham pitched his tent. Hebron (HEB-run) — "Alliance, association" Ancient city south of Jerusalem. Burial place of Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Rebekah, Jacob, and Leah.

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| <p>18 <i>Then Abram removed his tent, and came and dwelt in the plain of Mamre, which is in Hebron, and built there an altar unto the LORD.</i></p> | <p>So Abram moved his tent and came and lived by the oaks of Mamre, which are in Hebron, and there He built an altar to the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Perizzites (PEHR-ih-zytes) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Hebron (HEE-bron) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Jordan (JOR-dan) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Sodom (SOD-um) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Gen 24:35; Ps 112:1-3; Job 22:21-25; Gen 26:12-13; Prov 10:22
- v4 — Jer 29:12; Isa 58:9; Gen 12:7-8; Eph 6:18-19
- v6 — Gen 36:6-7; Luke 12:17-18; 1 Tim 6:9; Eccl 5:10-11
- v7 — Gen 26:20; Gen 12:6
- v8 — 1 Cor 6:6-7; Acts 7:26; Ps 133:1
- v10 — Deut 34:3; Isa 51:3; Gen 2:8-10; Gen 14:8

- v11 — Gen 13:9
- v12 — Gen 19:29; Gen 19:1; Gen 14:12
- v14 — Deut 3:27; Gen 28:14; Gen 13:10; Isa 49:18; Isa 60:4
- v15 — 2 Chr 20:7; Gen 15:18; Gen 12:7; Gen 35:12; Ps 37:29
- v16 — Gen 28:14; Num 23:10; Gen 32:12
- v18 — Gen 18:1; Gen 14:13; Gen 8:20; Gen 35:27; Gen 12:7-8

Chapter 14

Four eastern kings led by Chedorlaomer defeated the five kings of the Jordan plain and carried off Lot and his possessions from Sodom. Abram armed 318 trained men, pursued the invaders as far as Dan, and recovered Lot and all the goods. Melchizedek king of Salem blessed Abram and received a tenth of everything from him, while Abram refused to take anything from the king of Sodom.

■ **NAME NOTE** Chedorlaomer (*ked-or-LAY-o-mer*) — "Servant of Lagamar (an Elamite deity)" King of Elam who led the eastern coalition in the first war recorded in the Bible. Amraphel (*AM-ra-fel*) — "Uncertain — possibly "speaker of darkness"" King of Shinar (Babylon) in the eastern coalition. Arioch (*AIR-ee-ock*) — "Lion-like" King of Ellasar in the eastern coalition. Tidal (*TIE-dal*) — "Great son, reverence" King of nations (*Goiim*) in the eastern coalition.

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| 1 | And it came to pass in the days of Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Chedorlaomer king of Elam, and Tidal king of nations; | In the days of Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Chedorlaomer king of Elam, and Tidal king of nations, |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Bera (*BEER-uh*) — "Son of evil" King of Sodom during the war of the kings. Birsha (*BUR-shah*) — "Son of wickedness" King of Gomorrah. Shinab (*SHY-nab*) — "Father has turned" King of Admah. Shemeber (*SHEM-ee-bur*) — "Name of might" King of Zeboiim.

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| 2 | That these made war with Bera king of Sodom, and with Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, and Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela, which is Zoar. | these kings made war with Bera king of Sodom, Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar). |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Siddim (*SID-im*) — "Cultivated fields, furrows" The valley ("the Salt Sea") where the war of the kings was fought — full of tar pits.

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| 3 | All these were joined together in the vale of Siddim, which is the salt sea. | All these joined forces in the Valley of Siddim (that is, the Salt Sea). |
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| 4 | <i>Twelve years they served Chedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled.</i> | Twelve years they had served Chedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Rephaim* (REF-ay-im) — "Giants, shades" A race of giants in the land of Canaan. Defeated by Chedorlaomer and later displaced.

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| 5 | <i>And in the fourteenth year came Chedorlaomer, and the kings that were with him, and smote the Rephaims in Ashteroth Karnaim, and the Zuzims in Ham, and the Emims in Shaveh Kiriathaim,</i> | In the fourteenth year Chedorlaomer and the kings with him came and struck the Rephaim in Ashteroth-karnaim, the Zuzim in Ham, the Emim in Shaveh-kiriathaim, |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Horite* (HOR-ite) — "Cave-dweller" Pre-Edomite inhabitants of Mount Seir.

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| 6 | <i>And the Horites in their mount Seir, unto Elparan, which is by the wilderness.</i> | the Horites in their Mount Seir, as far as El-paran on the border of the wilderness. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Kadesh* (KAY-desh) — "Holy, sanctuary" Wilderness site on the southern border of Canaan. *Amalekite* (uh-MAL-eh-kite) — "Dweller in the valley" Descendants of Amalek. Later perennial enemies of Israel; first mentioned here before Amalek himself is born.

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| 7 | <i>And they returned, and came to Enmishpat, which is Kadesh, and smote all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites, that dwelt in Hazezontamar.</i> | Then they turned back and came to En-mishpat (that is, Kadesh) and struck down all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites who lived in Hazazon-tamar. |
| 8 | <i>And there went out the king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorrah, and the king of Admah, and the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (the same is Zoar;) and they joined battle with them in the vale of Siddim;</i> | Then the king of Sodom, the king of Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar) went out and joined battle in the Valley of Siddim |

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| <p>9 <i>With Chedorlaomer the king of Elam, and with Tidal king of nations, and Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar; four kings with five.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And the vale of Siddim was full of slimepits; and the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, and fell there; and they that remained fled to the mountain.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And they took all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah, and all their victuals, and went their way.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And they took Lot, Abram's brother's son, who dwelt in Sodom, and his goods, and departed.</i></p> | <p>against Chedorlaomer king of Elam, Tidal king of nations, Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar—four kings against five.</p> <p>Now the Valley of Siddim was full of tar pits, and as the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, some fell into them, and the rest fled to the hill country.</p> <p>So the enemy took all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah and all their provisions and went their way.</p> <p>They also took Lot, Abram's nephew, who was dwelling in Sodom, along with his possessions, and left.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Hebrew (HEE-broo) — "One from beyond (across the river)" First applied to Abram. Likely derived from Eber; marks Abraham as coming from across the Euphrates.

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| <p>13 <i>And there came one that had escaped, and told Abram the Hebrew; for he dwelt in the plain of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol, and brother of Aner; and these were confederate with Abram.</i></p> | <p>Then one who had escaped came and told Abram the Hebrew, who was dwelling by the oaks of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol and brother of Aner; these were allies of Abram.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Dan (DAN) — "Judge" Two meanings. First appears here as a place — the northern border city where Abraham pursued the kings. Later in Genesis 30, also the name Rachel gives to Bilhah's firstborn, who becomes one of the twelve tribes. The city was later named for him.

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| <p>14 <i>And when Abram heard that his brother was taken captive, he armed his trained servants, born in his own house, three hundred and eighteen, and pursued them unto Dan.</i></p> | <p>When Abram heard that his kinsman had been taken captive, he led out his trained men, born in his own house, 318 of them, and pursued as far as Dan.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Hobah (HO-bah) — "Hiding place" City north of Damascus; the limit of Abram's pursuit. Damascus (duh-MAS-kus) — "Activity, sack full of blood" Ancient city in Syria; still one of the oldest continuously inhabited cities in the world.*

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| <p>15 <i>And he divided himself against them, he and his servants, by night, and smote them, and pursued them unto Hobah, which is on the left hand of Damascus.</i></p> | <p>He divided his forces against them by night, he and his servants, and struck them down, and pursued them as far as Hobah, north of Damascus.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And he brought back all the goods, and also brought again his brother Lot, and his goods, and the women also, and the people.</i></p> | <p>He brought back all the goods, and also brought back his kinsman Lot with his possessions, and the women and the people.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Shaveh (SHAY-veh) — "Plain, equality" "The king's dale" — valley near Salem where the king of Sodom met Abram after the battle.*

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| <p>17 <i>And the king of Sodom went out to meet him after his return from the slaughter of Chedorlaomer, and of the kings that were with him, at the valley of Shaveh, which is the king's dale.</i></p> | <p>After his return from the defeat of Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him, the king of Sodom went out to meet him at the Valley of Shaveh (that is, the King's Valley).</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Melchizedek (mel-KIZ-uh-dek) — "King of righteousness" Priest-king of Salem (Jerusalem). Blessed Abram after the battle of the kings. In Hebrews, a type of Christ. Salem (SAY-lem) — "Peace" Later known as Jerusalem. Melchizedek's kingdom.*

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| <p>18 <i>And Melchizedek king of Salem brought forth bread and wine: and he was the priest of the most high God.</i></p> | <p>Melchizedek king of Salem brought out bread and wine. He was priest of God Most High.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And he blessed him, and said, Blessed be Abram of the most high God, possessor of heaven and earth:</i></p> | <p>He blessed Abram and said, 'Blessed be Abram by God Most High, Possessor of heaven and earth,</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And blessed be the most high God, which hath delivered thine enemies into thy hand. And he gave him tithes of all.</i></p> | <p>blessed be God Most High, who has delivered your enemies into your hand.' And Abram gave him a tenth of everything.</p> |

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| <p>21 <i>And the king of Sodom said unto Abram, Give me the persons, and take the goods to thyself.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Abram said to the king of Sodom, I have lift up mine hand unto the LORD, the most high God, the possessor of heaven and earth,</i></p> <p>23 <i>That I will not take from a thread even to a shoelatchet, and that I will not take any thing that is thine, lest thou shouldest say, I have made Abram rich:</i></p> <p>24 <i>Save only that which the young men have eaten, and the portion of the men which went with me, Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre; let them take their portion.</i></p> | <p>the king of Sodom said to Abram, 'Give me the people, and take the goods for yourself.'</p> <p>But Abram said to the king of Sodom, 'I have lifted up my hand to the LORD, God Most High, Possessor of heaven and earth,</p> <p>that I will not take a thread or a sandal strap or anything that is yours, lest you should say, I have made Abram rich.</p> <p>I will take nothing but what the young men have eaten, and the share of the men who went with me—Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. Let them take their share.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

victuals (VIT-ulz) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Dan (DAN) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 10:10
- v2 — Gen 13:10; Deut 29:23; Gen 10:19
- v3 — Num 34:12; Josh 3:16; Deut 3:17
- v6 — Deut 2:22; Deut 2:12; Gen 21:21
- v7 — 2 Chr 20:2
- v13 — Gen 13:18
- v14 — Judg 18:29; Gen 15:3
- v18 — Heb 6:20-7:3; Ps 110:4; Heb 5:6; Heb 5:10; Ps 76:2
- v19 — Heb 7:6-7; Gen 14:22; Ps 24:1; Ruth 3:10; Num 6:23-27
- v20 — Gen 28:22; Neh 13:12; Heb 7:4-9; Deut 14:28; Mal 3:10
- v23 — 2 Kgs 5:16

Chapter 15

The LORD appeared to Abram in a vision, promised him an heir from his own body, and told him to count the stars — so would his seed be. Abram believed the LORD, and it was counted to him as righteousness. God made a covenant with Abram, foretelling that his descendants would be strangers and servants in a foreign land for 400 years before returning to possess the land from the river of Egypt to the Euphrates.

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| <p>1 <i>After these things the word of the LORD came unto Abram in a vision, saying, Fear not, Abram: I am thy shield, and thy exceeding great reward.</i></p> | <p>After these things the word of the LORD came to Abram in a vision, saying, 'Do not fear, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Eliezer (el-ih-EE-zer) — "God is help" Abraham's chief servant from Damascus, who would have been his heir before Isaac was born.*

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| <p>2 <i>And Abram said, Lord GOD, what wilt thou give me, seeing I go childless, and the steward of my house is this Eliezer of Damascus?</i></p> | <p>But Abram said, 'Lord GOD, what will You give me, since I go childless, and the heir of my house is Eliezer of Damascus?'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Abram said, Behold, to me thou hast given no seed: and, lo, one born in my house is mine heir.</i></p> | <p>Abram said, 'you have given me no seed, and a servant born in my house is my heir.'</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And, behold, the word of the LORD came unto him, saying, This shall not be thine heir; but he that shall come forth out of thine own bowels shall be thine heir.</i></p> | <p>Then the word of the LORD came to Him, saying, 'This man shall not be your heir; your own son shall be Your heir.'</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And he brought him forth abroad, and said, Look now toward heaven, and tell the stars, if thou be able to number them: and he said unto him, So shall thy seed be.</i></p> | <p>He brought Him outside and said, 'Look now toward the heavens and count the stars, if You are able to count them.' Then He said to Him, 'So shall Your seed be.'</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.</i></p> | <p>Abram believed the LORD. He counted it to Him as righteousness.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And he said unto him, I am the LORD that brought thee out of Ur of the Chaldees, to give thee this land to inherit it.</i></p> | <p>He said to Him, 'I am the LORD Who brought You out of Ur of the Chaldees, to give You this land to inherit it.'</p> |

- 8 *And he said, Lord GOD, whereby shall I know that I shall inherit it?* But Abram said, 'Lord GOD, how shall I know that I will inherit it?'
- 9 *And he said unto him, Take me an heifer of three years old, and a she goat of three years old, and a ram of three years old, and a turtledove, and a young pigeon.* He said to Him, 'Bring me a heifer three years old, a female goat three years old, a ram three years old, a turtledove, and a young pigeon.'
- 10 *And he took unto him all these, and divided them in the midst, and laid each piece one against another: but the birds divided he not.* So He brought Him all these, cut them in two, and laid each half opposite the other. But He did not cut the birds in two.
- 11 *And when the fowls came down upon the carcasses, Abram drove them away.* When birds of prey came down on the carcasses, Abram drove them away.
- 12 *And when the sun was going down, a deep sleep fell upon Abram; and, lo, an horror of great darkness fell upon him.* As the sun was going down, a deep sleep fell on Abram, and a dreadful great darkness fell upon him.
- 13 *And he said unto Abram, Know of a surety that thy seed shall be a stranger in a land that is not theirs, and shall serve them; and they shall afflict them four hundred years;* Then he said to Abram, 'Know for certain that your seed will be sojourners in a land that is not theirs. They will be servants there. They will be afflicted for 400 years.
- 14 *And also that nation, whom they shall serve, will I judge: and afterward shall they come out with great substance.* But I will also judge the nation whom they serve, and afterward they shall come out with great possessions.
- 15 *And thou shalt go to thy fathers in peace; thou shalt be buried in a good old age.* As for you, you shall go to your fathers in peace; you shall be buried at a good old age.
- 16 *But in the fourth generation they shall come hither again: for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full.* In the fourth generation they shall come back here, for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet complete.'

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And it came to pass, that, when the sun went down, and it was dark, behold a smoking furnace, and a burning lamp that passed between those pieces.
- When the sun had gone down and it was dark, a smoking fire pot and a flaming torch passed between these pieces.
- 18

In the same day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying, Unto thy seed have I given this land, from the river of Egypt unto the great river, the river Euphrates:
- On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying, 'To your seed I have given this land, from the river of Egypt to the great river, the river Euphrates,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Kenite (KEN-ite) — "Smiths" Tribe listed among the peoples whose land was promised to Abraham's offspring. Kenizzite (KEN-iz-ite) — "Hunter" Tribe in Canaan, part of the promised inheritance. Kadmonite (KAD-mon-ite) — "Easterner, ancient" Eastern tribe listed in the promise to Abraham.*

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The Kenites, and the Kenizzites, and the Kadmonites,
- The Kenites, the Kenizzites, the Kadmonites,
- 20

And the Hittites, and the Perizzites, and the Rephaims,
- The Hittites, the Perizzites, the Rephaim,
- 21

And the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Girgashites, and the Jebusites.
- The Amorites, the Canaanites, the Girgashites, and the Jebusites.'

Words in this chapter:

Girgashites (*GER-gah-shytes*) — One of the seven Canaanite nations — listed among the peoples that Israel displaced; little else is known about them beyond their name.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Isa 41:10; Ps 119:114; Ps 84:11; Heb 13:5-6; Gen 26:24
- v5** — Heb 11:12; Rom 4:18; Deut 1:10; Ex 32:13; Gen 22:17
- v6** — Jas 2:23; Gal 3:6-14; Rom 4:9; Rom 4:20-25; Rom 4:3-6
- v8** — Luke 1:18; Luke 1:34; Isa 7:11; 2 Kgs 20:8
- v10** — Lev 1:17; Jer 34:18-19

v12 — Gen 2:21; Job 33:15

v13 — Acts 7:6-7; Ex 1:11; Ex 12:40-41; Acts 7:17

v14 — Neh 9:9-11; Ex 6:5-6; Ex 12:32-38; Josh 24:4-7

v15 — Job 5:26; Gen 25:7-9; 2 Chr 34:28; Num 27:13; Dan 12:13

v16 — 1 Kgs 21:26; Dan 8:23; 1 Thess 2:16; Ex 12:40; Matt 23:32-35

v17 — Jer 34:18-19; Judg 6:21

v18 — Josh 1:3-4; Gen 12:7; Gen 13:15; Gen 24:7; Deut 11:24

Chapter 16

Sarai, still childless, gave her Egyptian maidservant Hagar to Abram as a wife; Hagar conceived and began to despise Sarai. Sarai dealt harshly with Hagar, who fled into the wilderness, where the angel of the LORD found her and told her to return, promising her son would father a multitude. Hagar bore Abram a son, and he named him Ishmael.

■ **NAME NOTE** Hagar (HAY-gar) — "Flight, stranger" Sarai's Egyptian maidservant; mother of Ishmael. Encountered the angel of the LORD at a well in the wilderness.

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| <p>1 <i>Now Sarai Abram's wife bare him no children: and she had an handmaid, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar.</i></p> | Now Sarai, Abram's wife, had borne him no children. She had an Egyptian maidservant whose name was Hagar. |
| <p>2 <i>And Sarai said unto Abram, Behold now, the LORD hath restrained me from bearing: I pray thee, go in unto my maid; it may be that I may obtain children by her. And Abram hearkened to the voice of Sarai.</i></p> | So Sarai said to Abram, 'now, the LORD has kept me from bearing children. Please go in to my maidservant; perhaps I can obtain children through her.' And Abram listened to the voice of Sarai. |
| <p>3 <i>And Sarai Abram's wife took Hagar her maid the Egyptian, after Abram had dwelt ten years in the land of Canaan, and gave her to her husband Abram to be his wife.</i></p> | So Sarai, Abram's wife, took Hagar the Egyptian, her maidservant, after Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, and gave her to her husband Abram to be his wife. |
| <p>4 <i>And he went in unto Hagar, and she conceived: and when she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.</i></p> | He went in to Hagar. She conceived. And when she saw that she had conceived, she looked with contempt on her mistress. |

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| <p>5 <i>And Sarai said unto Abram, My wrong be upon thee: I have given my maid into thy bosom; and when she saw that she had conceived, I was despised in her eyes: the LORD judge between me and thee.</i></p> <p>6 <i>But Abram said unto Sarai, Behold, thy maid is in thy hand; do to her as it pleaseth thee. And when Sarai dealt hardly with her, she fled from her face.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the angel of the LORD found her by a fountain of water in the wilderness, by the fountain in the way to Shur.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And he said, Hagar, Sarai's maid, whence camest thou? and whither wilt thou go? And she said, I flee from the face of my mistress Sarai.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And the angel of the LORD said unto her, Return to thy mistress, and submit thyself under her hands.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And the angel of the LORD said unto her, I will multiply thy seed exceedingly, that it shall not be numbered for multitude.</i></p> | <p>Then Sarai said to Abram, 'May the wrong done to me be on you. I gave my maidservant into your embrace, and when she saw that she had conceived, she looked on me with contempt. May the LORD judge between you and me.'</p> <p>But Abram said to Sarai, ' your maidservant is in your hand; do to her as you please.' Then Sarai dealt harshly with her. She fled from her presence.</p> <p>The angel of the LORD found her by a spring of water in the wilderness, the spring on the way to Shur.</p> <p>He said, 'Hagar, Sarai's maidservant, where have You come from, and where are You going?' She said, 'I am fleeing from the presence of my mistress Sarai.'</p> <p>The angel of the LORD said to her, 'Return to Your mistress and submit Yourself under her hand.'</p> <p>The angel of the LORD also said to her, 'I will greatly multiply Your seed so that they shall be too numerous to count.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Ishmael (ISH-may-el) — "God hears" Son of Abram and Hagar. Father of twelve princes and the Arab peoples. Named by God before his birth.

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| <p>11 <i>And the angel of the LORD said unto her, Behold, thou art with child, and shalt bear a son, and shalt call his name Ishmael; because the LORD hath heard thy affliction.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And he will be a wild man; his hand will be against every man, and every man's hand against him; and he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And she called the name of the LORD that spake unto her, Thou God seest me: for she said, Have I also here looked after him that seeth me?</i></p> | <p>The angel of the LORD said to her, 'You are with child and shall bear a son. You shall call His name Ishmael, because the LORD has heard Your affliction.</p> <p>He shall be a wild man; His hand will be against every man, and every man's hand against him. He shall dwell in the presence of all His brothers.'</p> <p>So she called the name of the LORD Who spoke to her, 'You are the God Who sees me,' for she said, 'Have I really seen here Him who sees me?'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Beerlahairoi (BEER-lah-HI-roy) — "Well of the Living One who sees me" The well in the wilderness where the angel of the LORD found Hagar. Bered (BEER-ed) — "Hail" Location near Beer-lahai-roi.

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| <p>14 <i>Wherefore the well was called Beerlahairoi; behold, it is between Kadesh and Bered.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Hagar bare Abram a son: and Abram called his son's name, which Hagar bare, Ishmael.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And Abram was fourscore and six years old, when Hagar bare Ishmael to Abram.</i></p> | <p>Therefore the well was called Beer-lahai-roi; it is between Kadesh and Bered.</p> <p>Hagar bore Abram a son, and Abram called the name of his son, whom Hagar bore, Ishmael.</p> <p>Abram was 86 years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Hagar (HAY-gar) — Sarah's Egyptian handmaid — given to Abraham as a wife; mother of Ishmael; met the angel of the LORD at the well in the wilderness.

Ishmael (ISH-mee-el) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gal 4:24; Gen 12:16; Gen 15:2-3; Gen 21:9-10

- v5 — Gen 31:53
- v7 — Gen 21:17; Ex 15:22; Gen 25:18
- v8 — Gen 3:9; Gen 4:10
- v10 — Gen 17:20
- v11 — Ex 2:23-24; Ex 3:7; Isa 7:14; 1 Sam 1:20; Gen 41:51-52
- v12 — Gen 21:20; Gen 25:18; Job 39:5-8
- v13 — Ps 139:1-12; Gen 32:30; Prov 15:3; Prov 5:21; Gen 16:7

Chapter 17

When Abram was 99, the LORD appeared and established the covenant of circumcision, renaming him Abraham and Sarai as Sarah. God promised that Sarah would bear a son named Isaac, through whom the everlasting covenant would continue. Abraham circumcised every male in his household that same day, as God had commanded.

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| <p>1 <i>And when Abram was ninety years old and nine, the LORD appeared to Abram, and said unto him, I am the Almighty God; walk before me, and be thou perfect.</i></p> | <p>When Abram was 99 years old, the LORD appeared to Abram and said to him, 'I am God Almighty; walk before me and be blameless.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And I will make my covenant between me and thee, and will multiply thee exceedingly.</i></p> | <p>I will make my covenant between me and You, and will multiply You greatly.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Abram fell on his face: and God talked with him, saying,</i></p> | <p>Then Abram fell on his face. God spoke with Him, saying,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>As for me, behold, my covenant is with thee, and thou shalt be a father of many nations.</i></p> | <p>'As for me, my covenant is with you, and you shall be the father of many nations.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** Abraham (AY-bruh-ham) — "Father of a multitude" Renamed from Abram by God in Genesis 17 when the covenant of circumcision was established. Lived 175 years.

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| <p>5 <i>Neither shall thy name any more be called Abram, but thy name shall be Abraham; for a father of many nations have I made thee.</i></p> | <p>No longer shall your name be called Abram, but your name shall be Abraham, for I have made you the father of many nations.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And I will make thee exceeding fruitful, and I will make nations of thee, and kings shall come out of thee.</i></p> | <p>I will make you greatly fruitful. I will make nations of you, and kings shall come from you.</p> |

- 7 *And I will establish my covenant between me and thee and thy seed after thee in their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be a God unto thee, and to thy seed after thee.* I will establish my covenant between me and you and your seed after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be God to you and to your seed after you.
- 8 *And I will give unto thee, and to thy seed after thee, the land wherein thou art a stranger, all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession; and I will be their God.* I will give to you and to your seed after you the land of your sojournings, all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession. I will be their God.'
- 9 *And God said unto Abraham, Thou shalt keep my covenant therefore, thou, and thy seed after thee in their generations.* God said to Abraham, 'As for you, you shall keep my covenant, you and your seed after you throughout their generations.
- 10 *This is my covenant, which ye shall keep, between me and you and thy seed after thee; Every man child among you shall be circumcised.* This is my covenant which you shall keep, between me and you and your seed after you: every male among you shall be circumcised.
- 11 *And ye shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin; and it shall be a token of the covenant betwixt me and you.* You shall be circumcised in the flesh of your foreskin. It shall be a sign of the covenant between me and you.
- 12 *And he that is eight days old shall be circumcised among you, every man child in your generations, he that is born in the house, or bought with money of any stranger, which is not of thy seed.* He who is eight days old among you shall be circumcised, every male throughout your generations, whether born in your house or bought with money from any foreigner who is not of your seed.
- 13 *He that is born in thy house, and he that is bought with thy money, must needs be circumcised: and my covenant shall be in your flesh for an everlasting covenant.* Both he who is born in your house and he who is bought with your money must be circumcised. So my covenant shall be in your flesh as an everlasting covenant.

- 14 *And the uncircumcised man child whose flesh of his foreskin is not circumcised, that soul shall be cut off from his people; he hath broken my covenant.* Any uncircumcised male who is not circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin shall be cut off from his people; he has broken my covenant.'

■ NAME NOTE Sarah (SAIR-uh) — "Princess" Renamed from Sarai in Genesis 17. Bore Isaac at age 90. Lived 127 years.

- 15 *And God said unto Abraham, As for Sarai thy wife, thou shalt not call her name Sarai, but Sarah shall her name be.* God said to Abraham, 'As for Sarai your wife, you shall not call her name Sarai, but Sarah shall be her name.'
- 16 *And I will bless her, and give thee a son also of her: yea, I will bless her, and she shall be a mother of nations; kings of people shall be of her.* I will bless her, and moreover I will give you a son by her. I will bless her. She shall become nations; kings of peoples shall come from her.'
- 17 *Then Abraham fell upon his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, Shall a child be born unto him that is an hundred years old? and shall Sarah, that is ninety years old, bear?* Then Abraham fell on his face and laughed, and said in his heart, 'Shall a child be born to a man who is 100 years old? Shall Sarah, who is 90 years old, bear a child?'
- 18 *And Abraham said unto God, O that Ishmael might live before thee!* Abraham said to God, 'Oh that Ishmael might live before you!'

■ NAME NOTE Isaac (EYE-zik) — "He laughs" Son of promise to Abraham and Sarah. Named for the laughter of both parents at the promise. Nearly sacrificed on Moriah.

- 19 *And God said, Sarah thy wife shall bear thee a son indeed; and thou shalt call his name Isaac: and I will establish my covenant with him for an everlasting covenant, and with his seed after him.* But God said, 'Sarah your wife shall indeed bear you a son, and you shall call his name Isaac. I will establish my covenant with him as an everlasting covenant, and with his seed after him.'

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| <p>20 <i>And as for Ishmael, I have heard thee: Behold, I have blessed him, and will make him fruitful, and will multiply him exceedingly; twelve princes shall he beget, and I will make him a great nation.</i></p> <p>21 <i>But my covenant will I establish with Isaac, which Sarah shall bear unto thee at this set time in the next year.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And he left off talking with him, and God went up from Abraham.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And Abraham took Ishmael his son, and all that were born in his house, and all that were bought with his money, every male among the men of Abraham's house; and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in the selfsame day, as God had said unto him.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And Abraham was ninety years old and nine, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And Ishmael his son was thirteen years old, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.</i></p> <p>26 <i>In the selfsame day was Abraham circumcised, and Ishmael his son.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And all the men of his house, born in the house, and bought with money of the stranger, were circumcised with him.</i></p> | <p>As for Ishmael, I have heard you. I have blessed him. I will make him fruitful and multiply him greatly. He shall father twelve princes. I will make him a great nation.</p> <p>But I will establish my covenant with Isaac, whom Sarah shall bear to you at this set time next year.'</p> <p>When he had finished talking with him, God went up from Abraham.</p> <p>Then Abraham took Ishmael his son and all those born in his house and all those bought with his money—every male among the men of Abraham's house—and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin that very day, as God had said to him.</p> <p>Abraham was 99 years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.</p> <p>Ishmael his son was 13 years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.</p> <p>That very day Abraham and his son Ishmael were circumcised.</p> <p>All the men of his house, those born in the house and those bought with money from a foreigner, were circumcised with him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Phil 4:13; Eph 3:20; Luke 1:6; Gen 18:14; Gen 6:9
- v2 — Gen 17:4-6; Gen 12:2; Gen 13:16; Ps 105:8-11; Gen 15:18
- v5 — Matt 1:21-23; Neh 9:7; Rom 4:17; Gen 17:15
- v6 — Gen 17:4; Gen 35:11; Matt 1:6-17; Gen 17:16
- v7 — Rom 9:7-9; Acts 2:39; Gen 26:24; Gen 15:18; Heb 8:10
- v8 — Lev 26:12; Ps 105:11; Gen 12:7; Ex 6:7; Gen 13:15
- v10 — Col 2:11-12; Gal 5:3-6; Rom 4:9-11; Acts 7:8
- v12 — Lev 12:3; Luke 2:21; Luke 1:59; Ex 12:48-49; Phil 3:5
- v17 — Rom 4:19-20; Gen 18:12; Rev 11:16; John 8:56; Gen 17:3
- v19 — Luke 1:13-20; Gen 21:2-3; Gen 21:6; 2 Kgs 4:16-17; Gen 18:10-14
- v20 — Gen 21:18; Gen 21:13
- v21 — Gen 21:2-3; Gen 26:2-5

Chapter 18

Three visitors came to Abraham at the oaks of Mamre; he prepared a meal for them, and the LORD promised that Sarah would bear a son within a year — Sarah laughed when she heard it. The LORD revealed to Abraham his plan to judge Sodom and Gomorrah, and Abraham interceded, bargaining the LORD down from fifty righteous to ten as grounds for sparing the city.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD appeared unto him in the plains of Mamre: and he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day;</i></p> | <p>The LORD appeared to Abraham by the oaks of Mamre as he sat at the tent door in the heat of the day.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he lift up his eyes and looked, and, lo, three men stood by him: and when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself toward the ground,</i></p> | <p>He lifted up His eyes and looked, and three men stood in front of Him. When He saw them, He ran from the tent door to meet them and bowed Himself to the ground.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And said, My Lord, if now I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away, I pray thee, from thy servant:</i></p> | <p>He said, 'My Lord, if I have found favor in Your sight, please do not pass by Your servant.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Let a little water, I pray you, be fetched, and wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree:</i></p> | <p>Let a little water be brought, and wash Your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree,</p> |

- 5 *And I will fetch a morsel of bread, and comfort ye your hearts; after that ye shall pass on: for therefore are ye come to your servant. And they said, So do, as thou hast said.* while I bring a morsel of bread, that You may refresh yourselves; after that You may pass on—since You have come to Your servant.' And they said, 'Do as You have said.'
- 6 *And Abraham hastened into the tent unto Sarah, and said, Make ready quickly three measures of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes upon the hearth.* So Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah and said, 'Quick, three measures of fine flour! Knead it and make cakes.'
- 7 *And Abraham ran unto the herd, and fetcht a calf tender and good, and gave it unto a young man; and he hasted to dress it.* Abraham ran to the herd, took a tender and good calf, and gave it to a young man, who hurried to prepare it.
- 8 *And he took butter, and milk, and the calf which he had dressed, and set it before them; and he stood by them under the tree, and they did eat.* Then he took curds and milk and the calf that he had prepared, and set it before them. He stood by them under the tree while they ate.
- 9 *And they said unto him, Where is Sarah thy wife? And he said, Behold, in the tent.* They said to him, 'Where is Sarah your wife?' And he said, 'in the tent.'
- 10 *And he said, I will certainly return unto thee according to the time of life; and, lo, Sarah thy wife shall have a son. And Sarah heard it in the tent door, which was behind him.* The LORD said, 'I will surely return to You about this time next year, and Sarah your wife shall have a son.' And Sarah was listening at the tent door behind him.
- 11 *Now Abraham and Sarah were old and well stricken in age; and it ceased to be with Sarah after the manner of women.* Now Abraham and Sarah were old, advanced in age; it had ceased to be with Sarah after the manner of women.
- 12 *Therefore Sarah laughed within herself, saying, After I am waxed old shall I have pleasure, my lord being old also?* So Sarah laughed to herself, saying, 'After I have grown old, shall I have pleasure, my lord also being old?'

- 13 *And the LORD said unto Abraham, Wherefore did Sarah laugh, saying, Shall I of a surety bear a child, which am old?* The LORD said to Abraham, 'Why did Sarah laugh and say, Shall I indeed bear a child, now that I am old?
- 14 *Is any thing too hard for the LORD? At the time appointed I will return unto thee, according to the time of life, and Sarah shall have a son.* Is anything too hard for the LORD? At the appointed time I will return to You, about this time next year, and Sarah shall have a son.'
- 15 *Then Sarah denied, saying, I laughed not; for she was afraid. And he said, Nay; but thou didst laugh.* But Sarah denied it, saying, 'I did not laugh,' for she was afraid. And he said, 'No, but you did laugh.'
- 16 *And the men rose up from thence, and looked toward Sodom: and Abraham went with them to bring them on the way.* Then the men set out from there and looked toward Sodom, and Abraham went with them to send them on their way.
- 17 *And the LORD said, Shall I hide from Abraham that thing which I do;* The LORD said, 'Shall I hide from Abraham what I am about to do,
- 18 *Seeing that Abraham shall surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth shall be blessed in him?* seeing that Abraham shall surely become a great and mighty nation. All the nations of the earth shall be blessed in him?
- 19 *For I know him, that he will command his children and his household after him, and they shall keep the way of the LORD, to do justice and judgment; that the LORD may bring upon Abraham that which he hath spoken of him.* For I have chosen Him, that He may command His children and his household after Him to keep the way of the LORD by doing righteousness and justice, so that the LORD may bring to Abraham what he has promised him.'
- 20 *And the LORD said, Because the cry of Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grievous;* Then the LORD said, 'Because the outcry against Sodom and Gomorrah is great and their sin is very grievous,

- 21 *I will go down now, and see whether they have done altogether according to the cry of it, which is come unto me; and if not, I will know.* I will go down now and see whether they have done altogether according to the outcry that has come to me. If not, I will know.'
- 22 *And the men turned their faces from thence, and went toward Sodom: but Abraham stood yet before the LORD.* So the men turned from there and went toward Sodom, but Abraham still stood before the LORD.
- 23 *And Abraham drew near, and said, Wilt thou also destroy the righteous with the wicked?* Then Abraham drew near and said, 'Will you indeed sweep away the righteous with the wicked?
- 24 *Peradventure there be fifty righteous within the city: wilt thou also destroy and not spare the place for the fifty righteous that are therein?* Suppose there are fifty righteous within the city. Will you indeed sweep it away and not spare the place for the sake of the fifty righteous who are in it?
- 25 *That be far from thee to do after this manner, to slay the righteous with the wicked: and that the righteous should be as the wicked, that be far from thee: Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?* Far be it from you to do such a thing—to slay the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous fare as the wicked! Far be it from you! Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?'
- 26 *And the LORD said, If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare all the place for their sakes.* The LORD said, 'If I find at Sodom fifty righteous in the city, I will spare the whole place for their sake.'
- 27 *And Abraham answered and said, Behold now, I have taken upon me to speak unto the Lord, which am but dust and ashes:* Abraham answered and said, 'I have taken upon myself to speak to the Lord, though I am but dust and ashes.
- 28 *Peradventure there shall lack five of the fifty righteous: wilt thou destroy all the city for lack of five? And he said, If I find there forty and five, I will not destroy it.* Suppose five of the fifty righteous are lacking. Will you destroy the whole city for lack of five?' And he said, 'I will not destroy it if I find 45 there.'

- 29 *And he spake unto him yet again, and said, Peradventure there shall be forty found there. And he said, I will not do it for forty's sake.* Again he spoke to him and said, 'Suppose 40 are found there.' He answered, 'I will not do it for the sake of 40.'
- 30 *And he said unto him, Oh let not the Lord be angry, and I will speak: Peradventure there shall thirty be found there. And he said, I will not do it, if I find thirty there.* Then he said, 'Let not the Lord be angry. I will speak. Suppose 30 are found there.' He answered, 'I will not do it if I find 30 there.'
- 31 *And he said, Behold now, I have taken upon me to speak unto the Lord: Peradventure there shall be twenty found there. And he said, I will not destroy it for twenty's sake.* He said, 'I have taken upon myself to speak to the Lord. Suppose 20 are found there.' He answered, 'For the sake of 20 I will not destroy it.'
- 32 *And he said, Oh let not the Lord be angry, and I will speak yet but this once: Peradventure ten shall be found there. And he said, I will not destroy it for ten's sake.* Then he said, 'Let not the Lord be angry. I will speak just once more. Suppose 10 are found there.' He answered, 'For the sake of 10 I will not destroy it.'
- 33 *And the LORD went his way, as soon as he had left communing with Abraham: and Abraham returned unto his place.* The LORD went on His way as soon as He had finished speaking with Abraham, and Abraham returned to his place.

Words in this chapter:

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 14:13; Gen 13:18; Gen 48:3; Gen 26:2; Gen 17:22

v2 — Heb 13:2; Gen 18:22; Gen 19:1; Judg 13:3; Gen 23:7

v4 — Gen 24:32; Gen 43:24; Gen 19:2; Luke 7:44

v10 — Gen 21:2; Gen 17:21; Rom 9:8-9
v12 — 1 Pet 3:6; Gen 17:17; Luke 1:18-20
v14 — Luke 1:37; Matt 19:26; Mark 10:27; Jer 32:27; Eph 3:20
v17 — Amos 3:7; Ps 25:14; John 15:15; Jas 2:23; Gen 19:24
v18 — Gal 3:8; Gen 26:4; Gal 3:14
v19 — 1 Tim 3:4-5; Deut 6:6-7; Deut 4:9-10; Eph 6:4; 2 Tim 3:15
v22 — Gen 19:1; Acts 7:55; 1 Tim 2:1; Ezek 22:30
v23 — Num 16:22; 2 Sam 24:17; Gen 20:4
v25 — Job 8:20; Isa 3:10-11; Job 8:3; Ps 58:11; Deut 32:4

Chapter 19

Two angels came to Sodom, and Lot took them in; the men of the city surrounded the house demanding the visitors, but the angels struck the mob with blindness and urged Lot to flee. The LORD rained fire and sulfur on Sodom and Gomorrah, destroying the cities of the plain; Lot's wife looked back and became a pillar of salt. Lot and his two daughters escaped to a cave in the hills, where his daughters bore him sons — Moab and Ben-ammi, fathers of the Moabites and Ammonites.

- 1 *And there came two angels to Sodom at even; and Lot sat in the gate of Sodom: and Lot seeing them rose up to meet them; and he bowed himself with his face toward the ground;* The two angels came to Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting in the gate of Sodom. When Lot saw them, he rose to meet them and bowed himself with his face to the ground.
- 2 *And he said, Behold now, my lords, turn in, I pray you, into your servant's house, and tarry all night, and wash your feet, and ye shall rise up early, and go on your ways. And they said, Nay; but we will abide in the street all night.* He said, 'now, my lords, please turn aside to your servant's house and spend the night and wash your feet. Then you may rise up early and go on your way.' They said, 'No; we will spend the night in the square.'
- 3 *And he pressed upon them greatly; and they turned in unto him, and entered into his house; and he made them a feast, and did bake unleavened bread, and they did eat.* But he urged them strongly, so they turned aside to him and entered his house. He made them a feast and baked unleavened bread. They ate.

- 4 *But before they lay down, the men of the city, even the men of Sodom, compassed the house round, both old and young, all the people from every quarter:* But before they lay down, the men of the city, the men of Sodom, surrounded the house, both young and old, all the people from every quarter.
- 5 *And they called unto Lot, and said unto him, Where are the men which came in to thee this night? bring them out unto us, that we may know them.* They called to Lot and said to him, 'Where are the men who came to you tonight? Bring them out to us, that we may know them.'
- 6 *And Lot went out at the door unto them, and shut the door after him,* Lot went out to them at the door, shutting the door behind him,
- 7 *And said, I pray you, brethren, do not so wickedly.* said, 'I beg you, my brothers, do not act so wickedly.
- 8 *Behold now, I have two daughters which have not known man; let me, I pray you, bring them out unto you, and do ye to them as is good in your eyes: only unto these men do nothing; for therefore came they under the shadow of my roof.* I have two daughters who have not known a man. Let me bring them out to you, and do to them as is good in your eyes. Only do nothing to these men, for they have come under the shelter of my roof.'
- 9 *And they said, Stand back. And they said again, This one fellow came in to sojourn, and he will needs be a judge: now will we deal worse with thee, than with them. And they pressed sore upon the man, even Lot, and came near to break the door.* But they said, 'Stand back!' And they said, 'This fellow came in to stay. He would be our judge! Now we will deal worse with you than with them.' Then they pressed hard against the man Lot and drew near to break the door.
- 10 *But the men put forth their hand, and pulled Lot into the house to them, and shut to the door.* But the men reached out their hands and pulled Lot into the house with them and shut the door.
- 11 *And they smote the men that were at the door of the house with blindness, both small and great: so that they wearied themselves to find the door.* They struck the men at the door of the house with blindness, both small and great, so that they wore themselves out trying to find the door.

- 12 *And the men said unto Lot, Hast thou here any besides? son in law, and thy sons, and thy daughters, and whatsoever thou hast in the city, bring them out of this place:* Then the men said to Lot, 'Have you anyone else here? Sons-in-law, your sons, your daughters, or anyone you have in the city, bring them out of the place.
- 13 *For we will destroy this place, because the cry of them is waxen great before the face of the LORD; and the LORD hath sent us to destroy it.* For we are about to destroy this place, because the outcry against them has become great before the LORD. The LORD has sent us to destroy it.'
- 14 *And Lot went out, and spake unto his sons in law, which married his daughters, and said, Up, get you out of this place; for the LORD will destroy this city. But he seemed as one that mocked unto his sons in law.* So Lot went out and spoke to his sons-in-law, who were to marry His daughters, and said, 'Get up, get out of this place, for the LORD is about to destroy the city.' But He seemed to His sons-in-law to be jesting.
- 15 *And when the morning arose, then the angels hastened Lot, saying, Arise, take thy wife, and thy two daughters, which are here; lest thou be consumed in the iniquity of the city.* When the morning dawned, the angels urged Lot, saying, 'Arise, take your wife and your two daughters who are here, or you will be swept away in the punishment of the city.'
- 16 *And while he lingered, the men laid hold upon his hand, and upon the hand of his wife, and upon the hand of his two daughters; the LORD being merciful unto him: and they brought him forth, and set him without the city.* But He lingered. So the men seized His hand and the hand of his wife and the hands of His two daughters, the LORD being merciful to Him. They brought Him out and set Him outside the city.
- 17 *And it came to pass, when they had brought them forth abroad, that he said, Escape for thy life; look not behind thee, neither stay thou in all the plain; escape to the mountain, lest thou be consumed.* When they had brought them outside, He said, 'Escape for Your life. Do not look behind You, and do not stop anywhere in the plain. Escape to the hills, lest You be swept away.'
- 18 *And Lot said unto them, Oh, not so, my Lord:* But Lot said to them, 'Oh, no, my lord!

- 19 *Behold now, thy servant hath found grace in thy sight, and thou hast magnified thy mercy, which thou hast shewed unto me in saving my life; and I cannot escape to the mountain, lest some evil take me, and I die:* your servant has found favor in your sight, and you have shown me great mercy in saving my life. But I cannot escape to the hills, lest the disaster overtake me and I die.
- 20 *Behold now, this city is near to flee unto, and it is a little one: Oh, let me escape thither, (is it not a little one?) and my soul shall live.* this city is near enough to flee to. It is a little one. Let me escape there—is it not a little one?—and my life shall be saved.'
- 21 *And he said unto him, See, I have accepted thee concerning this thing also, that I will not overthrow this city, for the which thou hast spoken.* He said to him, 'I grant you this favor also, that I will not overthrow the city of which you have spoken.
- 22 *Haste thee, escape thither; for I cannot do any thing till thou be come thither. Therefore the name of the city was called Zoar.* Hurry, escape there, for I can do nothing until you arrive there.'
- 23 *The sun was risen upon the earth when Lot entered into Zoar.* Therefore the name of the city was called Zoar.
- 24 *Then the LORD rained upon Sodom and upon Gomorrah brimstone and fire from the LORD out of heaven;* The sun had risen on the earth when Lot came to Zoar.
- 25 *And he overthrew those cities, and all the plain, and all the inhabitants of the cities, and that which grew upon the ground.* Then the LORD rained on Sodom and Gomorrah sulfur and fire from the LORD out of heaven.
- 26 *But his wife looked back from behind him, and she became a pillar of salt.* He overthrew those cities and all the plain, all the inhabitants of the cities, and what grew on the ground.
- 27 *And Abraham gat up early in the morning to the place where he stood before the LORD:* But Lot's wife looked back from behind him. She became a pillar of salt.
- Abraham went up early in the morning to the place where He had stood before the LORD.

- 28 *And he looked toward Sodom and Gomorrah, and toward all the land of the plain, and beheld, and, lo, the smoke of the country went up as the smoke of a furnace.* He looked down toward Sodom and Gomorrah and toward all the land of the plain. He saw the smoke of the land going up like the smoke of a furnace.
- 29 *And it came to pass, when God destroyed the cities of the plain, that God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out of the midst of the overthrow, when he overthrew the cities in the which Lot dwelt.* So it was, when God destroyed the cities of the plain, that God remembered Abraham and sent Lot out of the midst of the overthrow when he overthrew the cities in which Lot had lived.
- 30 *And Lot went up out of Zoar, and dwelt in the mountain, and his two daughters with him; for he feared to dwell in Zoar: and he dwelt in a cave, he and his two daughters.* Then Lot went up out of Zoar and lived in the hills with his two daughters, for he was afraid to dwell in Zoar. He and his two daughters lived in a cave.
- 31 *And the firstborn said unto the younger, Our father is old, and there is not a man in the earth to come in unto us after the manner of all the earth:* The firstborn said to the younger, 'Our father is old, and there is not a man on earth to come in to us after the manner of all the earth.
- 32 *Come, let us make our father drink wine, and we will lie with him, that we may preserve seed of our father.* Come, let us make our father drink wine. We will lie with him, that we may preserve seed from our father.'
- 33 *And they made their father drink wine that night: and the firstborn went in, and lay with her father; and he perceived not when she lay down, nor when she arose.* So they made their father drink wine that night, and the firstborn went in and lay with her father. He did not know when she lay down or when she arose.

- 34 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that the firstborn said unto the younger, Behold, I lay yesternight with my father: let us make him drink wine this night also; and go thou in, and lie with him, that we may preserve seed of our father.* The next day the firstborn said to the younger, 'I lay last night with my father. Let us make him drink wine tonight also, and you go in and lie with him, that we may preserve seed from our father.'
- 35 *And they made their father drink wine that night also: and the younger arose, and lay with him; and he perceived not when she lay down, nor when she arose.* So they made their father drink wine that night also, and the younger arose and lay with him. He did not know when she lay down or when she arose.
- 36 *Thus were both the daughters of Lot with child by their father.* Thus both the daughters of Lot were with child by their father.

■ **NAME NOTE** Moab (MO-ab) — "From father" Son of Lot by his elder daughter. Father of the Moabites, who settled east of the Dead Sea. Moabite (MO-ab-ite) — "From father (of Moab)" Descendants of Lot through his elder daughter.

- 37 *And the firstborn bare a son, and called his name Moab: the same is the father of the Moabites unto this day.* The firstborn bore a son and called his name Moab; he is the father of the Moabites to this day.

■ **NAME NOTE** Benammi (ben-AM-eye) — "Son of my people" Son of Lot by his younger daughter. Father of the Ammonites. Ammonite (AM-on-ite) — "Descendant of my people" Descendants of Lot through his younger daughter.

- 38 *And the younger, she also bare a son, and called his name Benammi: the same is the father of the children of Ammon unto this day.* The younger also bore a son and called his name Ben-ammi; he is the father of the Ammonites to this day.

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (AM-on-ytes) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Moabites (MO-ah-bytes) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Ammon (AM-on) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 13:2; Gen 18:22; Gen 18:1-5; Job 31:32
- v4 — Gen 13:13; Prov 4:16; Gen 18:20; Ex 23:2
- v5 — Judg 19:22; Isa 3:9; Jude 1:7; Lev 18:22; Rom 1:26-27
- v8 — Judg 19:24
- v9 — Ex 2:14
- v11 — 2 Kgs 6:18; Acts 13:11
- v12 — Gen 7:1; 2 Pet 2:7; Rev 18:4
- v14 — Num 16:21; Num 16:26; Jer 51:6; Num 16:45
- v17 — Matt 24:16-18; Luke 9:62; Phil 3:13-14; Gen 19:26; Gen 19:22
- v24 — Deut 29:23; Isa 13:19; 2 Pet 2:6; Amos 4:11; Jude 1:7
- v26 — Luke 17:31-32; Gen 19:17; Heb 10:38; Prov 14:14
- v28 — Rev 18:9; Rev 9:2

Chapter 20

Abraham moved to Gerar and again said Sarah was his sister; Abimelech king of Gerar took Sarah, but God warned him in a dream that she was another man's wife. Abimelech restored Sarah to Abraham along with livestock and servants. Abraham prayed, and God healed Abimelech and his household.

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| 1 | <i>And Abraham journeyed from thence toward the south country, and dwelled between Kadesh and Shur, and sojourned in Gerar.</i> | From there Abraham journeyed toward the south country and lived between Kadesh and Shur. He stayed in Gerar. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Abimelech (*uh-BIM-uh-lek*) — "My father is king" Title used by Philistine kings of Gerar. Abraham and later Isaac both had dealings with an Abimelech.

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| 2 | <i>And Abraham said of Sarah his wife, She is my sister: and Abimelech king of Gerar sent, and took Sarah.</i> | Abraham said of Sarah his wife, 'She is my sister.' And Abimelech king of Gerar sent and took Sarah. |
| 3 | <i>But God came to Abimelech in a dream by night, and said to him, Behold, thou art but a dead man, for the woman which thou hast taken; for she is a man's wife.</i> | But God came to Abimelech in a dream by night and said to Him, 'you are a dead man because of the woman you have taken, for she is a man's wife.' |

- 4 *But Abimelech had not come near her: and he said, Lord, wilt thou slay also a righteous nation?* Now Abimelech had not come near her. He said, 'Lord, will you slay even a righteous nation?
- 5 *Said he not unto me, She is my sister? and she, even she herself said, He is my brother: in the integrity of my heart and innocency of my hands have I done this.* Did he not himself say to me, She is my sister? And she herself said, He is my brother. In the integrity of my heart and the innocence of my hands I have done this.'
- 6 *And God said unto him in a dream, Yea, I know that thou didst this in the integrity of thy heart; for I also withheld thee from sinning against me: therefore suffered I thee not to touch her.* Then God said to Him in the dream, 'Yes, I know that you did this in the integrity of your heart. It was I who kept you from sinning against me. Therefore I did not let you touch her.
- 7 *Now therefore restore the man his wife; for he is a prophet, and he shall pray for thee, and thou shalt live: and if thou restore her not, know thou that thou shalt surely die, thou, and all that are thine.* Now therefore return the man's wife, for he is a prophet. He will pray for you, and you shall live. But if you do not return her, know that you shall surely die, you and all who are yours.'
- 8 *Therefore Abimelech rose early in the morning, and called all his servants, and told all these things in their ears: and the men were sore afraid.* So Abimelech rose early in the morning and called all his servants and told them all these things in their hearing. The men were very afraid.
- 9 *Then Abimelech called Abraham, and said unto him, What hast thou done unto us? and what have I offended thee, that thou hast brought on me and on my kingdom a great sin? thou hast done deeds unto me that ought not to be done.* Then Abimelech called Abraham and said to him, 'What have you done to us? How have I sinned against you, that you have brought on me and my kingdom a great sin? You have done to me things that ought not to be done.'
- 10 *And Abimelech said unto Abraham, What sawest thou, that thou hast done this thing?* Abimelech said to Abraham, 'What did you see, that you did this thing?'

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| 11 <i>And Abraham said, Because I thought, Surely the fear of God is not in this place; and they will slay me for my wife's sake.</i> | Abraham said, 'Because I thought, Surely there is no fear of God in this place. They will kill me because of my wife. |
| 12 <i>And yet indeed she is my sister; she is the daughter of my father, but not the daughter of my mother; and she became my wife.</i> | Besides, she really is my sister, the daughter of my father though not the daughter of my mother. She became my wife. |
| 13 <i>And it came to pass, when God caused me to wander from my father's house, that I said unto her, This is thy kindness which thou shalt shew unto me; at every place whither we shall come, say of me, He is my brother.</i> | when God caused me to wander from my father's house, I said to her, This is the kindness you must do for me: at every place we come to, say of me, He is my brother.' |
| 14 <i>And Abimelech took sheep, and oxen, and menservants, and womenservants, and gave them unto Abraham, and restored him Sarah his wife.</i> | Then Abimelech took sheep and oxen and male and female servants and gave them to Abraham, and returned Sarah his wife to him. |
| 15 <i>And Abimelech said, Behold, my land is before thee: dwell where it pleaseth thee.</i> | Abimelech said, ' my land is before you; dwell where it pleases you.' |
| 16 <i>And unto Sarah he said, Behold, I have given thy brother a thousand pieces of silver: behold, he is to thee a covering of the eyes, unto all that are with thee, and with all other: thus she was reprovèd.</i> | To Sarah he said, 'I have given your brother 1,000 pieces of silver. It is a covering of the eyes for you before all who are with you, and before everyone. Thus she was reprovèd.' |
| 17 <i>So Abraham prayed unto God: and God healed Abimelech, and his wife, and his maidservants; and they bare children.</i> | Then Abraham prayed to God. God healed Abimelech and his wife and female servants. They bore children. |
| 18 <i>For the LORD had fast closed up all the wombs of the house of Abimelech, because of Sarah Abraham's wife.</i> | For the LORD had closed fast all the wombs of the house of Abimelech because of Sarah, Abraham's wife. |

Words in this chapter:

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Gen 12:15; Gen 26:7
- v3 — Gen 20:7; Matt 27:19; Job 33:15; Ps 105:14
- v6 — 1 Sam 25:34; Prov 21:1; 1 Sam 25:26; Gen 31:7; Gen 35:5
- v7 — Job 42:8; 1 Sam 7:5; Heb 13:4
- v11 — Gen 26:7
- v14 — Gen 12:16
- v15 — Gen 34:10; Gen 13:9
- v17 — Jas 5:16; Job 42:9-10; Matt 21:22; Prov 15:8; Phil 4:6

Chapter 21

Sarah bore Isaac to Abraham in his old age, just as God had promised. Sarah demanded that Hagar and Ishmael be cast out; God told Abraham to listen to her and promised to make Ishmael a nation as well. God provided water for Hagar in the wilderness, and Abraham made a covenant with Abimelech at Beersheba.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD visited Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did unto Sarah as he had spoken.</i> | The LORD visited Sarah as he had said. The LORD did to Sarah as he had promised. |
| 2 <i>For Sarah conceived, and bare Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him.</i> | Sarah conceived and bore Abraham a son in his old age at the appointed time of which God had spoken to him. |
| 3 <i>And Abraham called the name of his son that was born unto him, whom Sarah bare to him, Isaac.</i> | Abraham called the name of his son who was born to him, whom Sarah bore him, Isaac. |
| 4 <i>And Abraham circumcised his son Isaac being eight days old, as God had commanded him.</i> | Abraham circumcised his son Isaac when he was eight days old, as God had commanded him. |
| 5 <i>And Abraham was an hundred years old, when his son Isaac was born unto him.</i> | Abraham was 100 years old when his son Isaac was born to him. |

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| <p>6 <i>And Sarah said, God hath made me to laugh, so that all that hear will laugh with me.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And she said, Who would have said unto Abraham, that Sarah should have given children suck? for I have born him a son in his old age.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And the child grew, and was weaned: and Abraham made a great feast the same day that Isaac was weaned.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Sarah saw the son of Hagar the Egyptian, which she had born unto Abraham, mocking.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Wherefore she said unto Abraham, Cast out this bondwoman and her son: for the son of this bondwoman shall not be heir with my son, even with Isaac.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And the thing was very grievous in Abraham's sight because of his son.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And God said unto Abraham, Let it not be grievous in thy sight because of the lad, and because of thy bondwoman; in all that Sarah hath said unto thee, hearken unto her voice; for in Isaac shall thy seed be called.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And also of the son of the bondwoman will I make a nation, because he is thy seed.</i></p> | <p>Sarah said, 'God has made me laugh; everyone who hears will laugh with me.'</p> <p>She also said, 'Who would have said to Abraham that Sarah would nurse children? Yet I have borne him a son in his old age.'</p> <p>The child grew and was weaned, and Abraham made a great feast on the day that Isaac was weaned.</p> <p>But Sarah saw the son of Hagar the Egyptian, whom she had borne to Abraham, mocking.</p> <p>So she said to Abraham, 'Cast out this bondwoman and her son, for the son of this bondwoman shall not be heir with my son Isaac.'</p> <p>The thing was very grievous in Abraham's sight on account of his son.</p> <p>But God said to Abraham, 'Do not let it be grievous in your sight because of the boy and because of your bondwoman. In all that Sarah says to you, listen to her voice, for through Isaac shall your seed be named.'</p> <p>also of the son of the bondwoman I will make a nation, because he is your seed.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Beersheba (beer-SHEE-bah) — "Well of the oath (or seven)" Named by Abraham after he and Abimelech swore an oath there. Southernmost border town of Israel.

- 14 *And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and took bread, and a bottle of water, and gave it unto Hagar, putting it on her shoulder, and the child, and sent her away: and she departed, and wandered in the wilderness of Beersheba.* So Abraham rose early in the morning, took bread and a skin of water, and gave them to Hagar, putting them on her shoulder, along with the child, and sent her away. She departed and wandered in the wilderness of Beersheba.
- 15 *And the water was spent in the bottle, and she cast the child under one of the shrubs.* When the water in the skin was gone, she put the child under one of the shrubs.
- 16 *And she went, and sat her down over against him a good way off, as it were a bowshot: for she said, Let me not see the death of the child. And she sat over against him, and lift up her voice, and wept.* Then she went and sat down opposite him a good way off, about a bowshot, for she said, 'Let me not see the death of the child.' And she sat opposite him and lifted up her voice and wept.
- 17 *And God heard the voice of the lad; and the angel of God called to Hagar out of heaven, and said unto her, What aileth thee, Hagar? fear not; for God hath heard the voice of the lad where he is.* God heard the voice of the boy, and the angel of God called to Hagar from heaven and said to her, 'What troubles you, Hagar? Do not fear, for God has heard the voice of the boy where he is.
- 18 *Arise, lift up the lad, and hold him in thine hand; for I will make him a great nation.* Arise, lift up the boy and hold him by the hand, for I will make him a great nation.'
- 19 *And God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water; and she went, and filled the bottle with water, and gave the lad drink.* Then God opened her eyes. She saw a well of water. She went and filled the skin with water and gave the boy a drink.
- 20 *And God was with the lad; and he grew, and dwelt in the wilderness, and became an archer.* God was with the boy. He grew up. He lived in the wilderness and became an archer.

■ **NAME NOTE** Paran (PAY-ran) — "Place of caverns" Wilderness region south of Canaan where Ishmael lived.

- 21 *And he dwelt in the wilderness of Paran: and his mother took him a wife out of the land of Egypt.* He lived in the wilderness of Paran. His mother took a wife for him from the land of Egypt.

■ NAME NOTE Phichol (FY-kol) — "Mouth of all" Commander of Abimelech's army in Gerar.

- 22 *And it came to pass at that time, that Abimelech and Phichol the chief captain of his host spake unto Abraham, saying, God is with thee in all that thou doest:* At that time Abimelech and Phichol, the commander of his army, spoke to Abraham, saying, 'God is with you in all that you do.'
- 23 *Now therefore swear unto me here by God that thou wilt not deal falsely with me, nor with my son, nor with my son's son: but according to the kindness that I have done unto thee, thou shalt do unto me, and to the land wherein thou hast sojourned.* Now therefore swear to me here by God that you will not deal falsely with me or with my children or with my descendants. According to the kindness I have shown you, you shall show to me and to the land where you have stayed.'
- 24 *And Abraham said, I will swear.* Abraham said, 'I will swear.'
- 25 *And Abraham reprov'd Abimelech because of a well of water, which Abimelech's servants had violently taken away.* Then Abraham rebuked Abimelech because of a well of water that Abimelech's servants had seized by force.
- 26 *And Abimelech said, I wot not who hath done this thing: neither didst thou tell me, neither yet heard I of it, but to day.* Abimelech said, 'I do not know who has done this thing. You did not tell me. I have not heard of it until today.'
- 27 *And Abraham took sheep and oxen, and gave them unto Abimelech; and both of them made a covenant.* So Abraham took sheep and oxen and gave them to Abimelech, and the two of them made a covenant.
- 28 *And Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the flock by themselves.* Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the flock by themselves.
- 29 *And Abimelech said unto Abraham, What mean these seven ewe lambs which thou hast set by themselves?* Abimelech said to Abraham, 'What is the meaning of these seven ewe lambs that you have set by themselves?'

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| 30 | <i>And he said, For these seven ewe lambs shalt thou take of my hand, that they may be a witness unto me, that I have digged this well.</i> | He said, 'These seven ewe lambs you shall take from my hand, that they may be a witness for me that I dug this well.' |
| 31 | <i>Wherefore he called that place Beersheba; because there they sware both of them.</i> | Therefore that place was called Beersheba, because there the two of them swore an oath. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Philistines (FIL-iss-teenz) — "Wanderers, immigrants" Same as above; the traditional English name.*

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| 32 | <i>Thus they made a covenant at Beersheba; then Abimelech rose up, and Phichol the chief captain of his host, and they returned into the land of the Philistines.</i> | So they made a covenant at Beersheba. Then Abimelech rose up, with Phichol the commander of his army. They returned to the land of the Philistines. |
| 33 | <i>And Abraham planted a grove in Beersheba, and called there on the name of the LORD, the everlasting God.</i> | Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in Beersheba and called there on the name of the LORD, the Everlasting God. |
| 34 | <i>And Abraham sojourned in the Philistines' land many days.</i> | Abraham stayed in the land of the Philistines many days. |

Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 12:6; Gen 18:10; Gen 18:14; Gal 4:23; Gen 17:19
- v2 — Gal 4:22; Heb 11:11; Acts 7:8; Gen 18:10; Gen 18:14
- v5 — Gen 17:17; Rom 4:19; Gen 17:1
- v6 — Ps 126:2; Isa 54:1; Gen 17:17; Luke 1:58; Isa 49:21
- v9 — Gal 4:29; Gen 16:15; Gal 4:22
- v10 — John 8:35; Gal 4:22-31; 1 John 2:19; Gen 36:6-7; 1 Pet 1:4
- v12 — Heb 11:18; Rom 9:7-8; Gen 17:19
- v13 — Gen 16:10; Gen 17:20; Gen 21:18; Gen 25:12-18
- v17 — Gen 16:11; Ps 50:15
- v19 — Num 22:31; 2 Kgs 6:17-20; Isa 35:5-6; Luke 24:16-31
- v22 — Josh 3:7; Gen 26:26; Gen 26:28; Gen 20:2; Isa 8:10
- v33 — 1 Tim 1:17; Isa 40:28; Ps 90:2; Jer 10:10; Gen 4:26

Chapter 22

God tested Abraham by commanding him to offer Isaac as a burnt offering on a mountain in the land of Moriah. Abraham obeyed, bound Isaac on the altar, and raised the knife, but the angel of the LORD stopped him and provided a ram caught in a thicket instead. God swore to bless Abraham and multiply his seed because he had not withheld his only son.

- 1 *And it came to pass after these things,* After these things God tempted that God did tempt Abraham, and said Abraham and said to him, 'Abraham!' unto him, Abraham: and he said, And he said, 'Here I am.' Behold, here I am.

■ **NAME NOTE** Moriah (mor-EYE-ah) — "Seen by the LORD, chosen by the LORD" The land/mountain where Abraham nearly offered Isaac. Later the site of Solomon's temple in Jerusalem.

- 2 *And he said, Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and get thee into the land of Moriah; and offer him there for a burnt offering upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of.* He said, 'Take now your son, your only son Isaac, whom you love, and go to the land of Moriah, and offer him there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains of which I will tell you.'
- 3 *And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and saddled his ass, and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son, and clave the wood for the burnt offering, and rose up, and went unto the place of which God had told him.* So Abraham rose early in the morning, saddled his donkey, took two of his young men with him and Isaac his son, split the wood for the burnt offering, and arose and went to the place of which God had told him.
- 4 *Then on the third day Abraham lifted up his eyes, and saw the place afar off.* On the third day Abraham lifted up his eyes and saw the place from afar.
- 5 *And Abraham said unto his young men, Abide ye here with the ass; and I and the lad will go yonder and worship, and come again to you.* Abraham said to his young men, 'Stay here with the donkey. I and the boy will go over there and worship. We will come back to you.'

- 6 *And Abraham took the wood of the burnt offering, and laid it upon Isaac his son; and he took the fire in his hand, and a knife; and they went both of them together.* Abraham took the wood of the burnt offering and laid it on Isaac his son. He took the fire in his hand and the knife, and the two of them walked on together.
- 7 *And Isaac spake unto Abraham his father, and said, My father: and he said, Here am I, my son. And he said, Behold the fire and the wood: but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?* Isaac spoke to Abraham his father and said, 'My father!' And he said, 'Here I am, my son.' He said, 'the fire and the wood, but where is the lamb for the burnt offering?'
- 8 *And Abraham said, My son, God will provide himself a lamb for a burnt offering: so they went both of them together.* Abraham said, 'My son, God will provide for himself the lamb for a burnt offering.' So the two of them walked on together.
- 9 *And they came to the place which God had told him of; and Abraham built an altar there, and laid the wood in order, and bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar upon the wood.* When they came to the place of which God had told him, Abraham built the altar there and laid the wood in order. He bound Isaac his son and laid him on the altar, on top of the wood.
- 10 *And Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to slay his son.* Then Abraham reached out his hand and took the knife to slay his son.
- 11 *And the angel of the LORD called unto him out of heaven, and said, Abraham, Abraham: and he said, Here am I.* But the angel of the LORD called to Him from heaven and said, 'Abraham, Abraham!' And he said, 'Here I am.'
- 12 *And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: for now I know that thou fearest God, seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.* He said, 'Do not lay Your hand on the boy, and do nothing to him. For now I know that You fear God, since You have not withheld Your son, Your only son, from me.'

- 13 *And Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold behind him a ram caught in a thicket by his horns: and Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering in the stead of his son.* Abraham lifted up his eyes and looked, and behind him was a ram caught in a thicket by its horns. Abraham went and took the ram and offered it up as a burnt offering in place of his son.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Jehovahjireh* (jeh-HO-vah-JY-reh) — "The LORD will provide" Name Abraham gave to the place where God provided the ram in place of Isaac.

- 14 *And Abraham called the name of that place Jehovahjireh: as it is said to this day, In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen.* So Abraham called the name of that place Jehovahjireh, as it is said to this day, 'In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen.'
- 15 *And the angel of the LORD called unto Abraham out of heaven the second time,* The angel of the LORD called to Abraham from heaven a second time,
- 16 *And said, By myself have I sworn, saith the LORD, for because thou hast done this thing, and hast not withheld thy son, thine only son:* said, 'By myself I have sworn, declares the LORD, because You have done this thing and have not withheld Your son, Your only son,
- 17 *That in blessing I will bless thee, and in multiplying I will multiply thy seed as the stars of the heaven, and as the sand which is upon the sea shore; and thy seed shall possess the gate of his enemies;* that I will surely bless You. I will surely multiply Your seed as the stars of the heavens and as the sand on the seashore. And Your seed shall possess the gate of their enemies,
- 18 *And in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed; because thou hast obeyed my voice.* in Your seed all the nations of the earth shall be blessed, because You have obeyed my voice.'
- 19 *So Abraham returned unto his young men, and they rose up and went together to Beersheba; and Abraham dwelt at Beersheba.* So Abraham returned to his young men. They arose and went together to Beersheba. And Abraham lived at Beersheba.

- 20 *And it came to pass after these things,* After these things it was told Abraham,
that it was told Abraham, saying, ' Milcah also has borne children to
Behold, Milcah, she hath also born your brother Nahor:
children unto thy brother Nahor;
- 21 *Huz his firstborn, and Buz his brother,* Huz his firstborn, Buz his brother,
and Kemuel the father of Aram, Kemuel the father of Aram,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Bethuel (beth-YOO-el) — "Man of God, God's abode" Son of Nahor and Milcah; father of Laban and Rebekah.*

- 22 *And Chesed, and Hazo, and Pildash,* Chesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, and
and Jidlaph, and Bethuel. Bethuel.'

■ **NAME NOTE** *Rebekah (reh-BEK-uh) — "To tie firmly, captivating" Daughter of Bethuel, wife of Isaac, mother of Jacob and Esau. Chosen at the well of Haran.*

- 23 *And Bethuel begat Rebekah: these* Bethuel begat Rebekah. These eight
eight Milcah did bear to Nahor, Milcah bore to Nahor, Abraham's
Abraham's brother. brother.
- 24 *And his concubine, whose name was* his concubine, whose name was
Reumah, she bare also Tebah, and Reumah, also bore Tebah, Gaham,
Gaham, and Thahash, and Maachah. Thahash, and Maachah.

Words in this chapter:

Rebekah (*reh-BEK-ah*) — Isaac's wife, brought from Mesopotamia — mother of Jacob and Esau; her name may mean 'to tie' or 'to bind.'

Jehovahjireh (*jeh-HO-vah-JY-reh*) — Hebrew name meaning 'The LORD will provide' — the name Abraham gave to the place where God provided the ram instead of Isaac.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Heb 11:17; Deut 8:2; Jas 2:21; Jas 1:12-14; 1 Pet 1:7
v2 — John 3:16; Rom 8:32; Heb 11:17; 1 John 4:9-10; Gen 22:12
v5 — Heb 11:19
v6 — John 19:17
v8 — John 1:36; John 1:29; Rev 5:12; Rev 13:8; Rev 7:14
v9 — Jas 2:21
v12 — Jas 2:21-22; Jas 2:18; 1 Sam 15:22; Matt 10:37-38; Rom 8:32
v14 — Gen 22:13; Ex 17:15; Judg 6:24; Gen 22:8; Gen 16:13-14
v16 — Heb 6:13-14; Luke 1:73; Ps 105:9; Jer 51:14; Jer 49:13
v17 — Gen 15:5; Gen 26:4; Gen 24:60; Jer 33:22; Ps 2:8-9

v18 — Acts 3:25; Gal 3:16; Gen 12:3; Gen 26:4-5; Gen 18:18
v20 — Gen 11:29

Chapter 23

Sarah died at the age of 127 in Hebron, and Abraham mourned for her. He negotiated with the sons of Heth and purchased the cave of Machpelah and its surrounding field from Ephron the Hittite for 400 shekels of silver. Abraham buried Sarah there — his first piece of land in Canaan.

- 1

And Sarah was an hundred and seven and twenty years old: these were the years of the life of Sarah.
- Sarah lived 127 years; these were the years of the life of Sarah.

■ **NAME NOTE** Kirjatharba (KEER-jath-AR-bah) — "City of Arba" Old name for Hebron. Arba was a great man of the Anakim.

- 2

And Sarah died in Kirjatharba; the same is Hebron in the land of Canaan: and Abraham came to mourn for Sarah, and to weep for her.
- Sarah died in Kiriath-arba (that is, Hebron) in the land of Canaan, and Abraham went in to mourn for Sarah and to weep for her.
- 3

And Abraham stood up from before his dead, and spake unto the sons of Heth, saying,
- Then Abraham rose up from before his dead and spoke to the sons of Heth, saying,
- 4

I am a stranger and a sojourner with you: give me a possession of a buryingplace with you, that I may bury my dead out of my sight.
- 'I am a stranger and a sojourner among you. Give me property for a burying place with you, that I may bury my dead out of my sight.'
- 5

And the children of Heth answered Abraham, saying unto him,
- The sons of Heth answered Abraham, saying to him,
- 6

Hear us, my lord: thou art a mighty prince among us: in the choice of our sepulchres bury thy dead; none of us shall withhold from thee his sepulchre, but that thou mayest bury thy dead.
- 'Hear us, my lord; you are a prince of God among us. Bury your dead in the choicest of our tombs. None of us will withhold from you His tomb for burying your dead.'
- 7

And Abraham stood up, and bowed himself to the people of the land, even to the children of Heth.
- Abraham rose and bowed to the people of the land, to the sons of Heth.

- 8 *And he communed with them, saying, If it be your mind that I should bury my dead out of my sight; hear me, and intreat for me to Ephron the son of Zohar,* He spoke with them, saying, 'If it is your will that I should bury my dead out of my sight, hear me and entreat for me Ephron the son of Zohar,

■ **NAME NOTE** Machpelah (mak-PEE-lah) — "Double, portion" The cave and field Abraham purchased from Ephron as a burial site. Patriarchal tomb.

- 9 *That he may give me the cave of Machpelah, which he hath, which is in the end of his field; for as much money as it is worth he shall give it me for a possession of a buryingplace amongst you.* that he may give me the cave of Machpelah, which he owns, which is at the end of his field. For the full price let him give it to me in your presence as property for a burying place.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Hittite (HIT-ite) — "Descendant of Heth" Major ancient near-eastern power based in Asia Minor; also a Canaanite branch in the land.

- 10 *And Ephron dwelt among the children of Heth: and Ephron the Hittite answered Abraham in the audience of the children of Heth, even of all that went in at the gate of his city, saying,* Now Ephron was sitting among the sons of Heth, and Ephron the Hittite answered Abraham in the hearing of the sons of Heth, of all who went in at the gate of his city, saying,
- 11 *Nay, my lord, hear me: the field give I thee, and the cave that is therein, I give it thee; in the presence of the sons of my people give I it thee: bury thy dead.* 'No, my lord, hear me. The field I give to you, and the cave that is in it I give to you. In the presence of the sons of my people I give it to you; bury your dead.'
- 12 *And Abraham bowed down himself before the people of the land.* Then Abraham bowed down before the people of the land.
- 13 *And he spake unto Ephron in the audience of the people of the land, saying, But if thou wilt give it, I pray thee, hear me: I will give thee money for the field; take it of me, and I will bury my dead there.* he spoke to Ephron in the hearing of the people of the land, saying, 'But if you will, please hear me. I will give the price of the field; accept it from me. I will bury my dead there.'

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| <p>14 <i>And Ephron answered Abraham, saying unto him,</i></p> <p>15 <i>My lord, hearken unto me: the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver; what is that betwixt me and thee? bury therefore thy dead.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And Abraham hearkened unto Ephron; and Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver, which he had named in the audience of the sons of Heth, four hundred shekels of silver, current money with the merchant.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the field of Ephron, which was in Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the field, and the cave which was therein, and all the trees that were in the field, that were in all the borders round about, were made sure</i></p> <p>18 <i>Unto Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all that went in at the gate of his city.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And after this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah before Mamre: the same is Hebron in the land of Canaan.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And the field, and the cave that is therein, were made sure unto Abraham for a possession of a buryingplace by the sons of Heth.</i></p> | <p>Ephron answered Abraham, saying to him,</p> <p>'My lord, listen to me. A piece of land worth 400 shekels of silver—what is that between me and you? Bury your dead.'</p> <p>Abraham listened to Ephron, and Abraham weighed out for Ephron the silver that he had named in the hearing of the sons of Heth: 400 shekels of silver, according to the weights current among the merchants.</p> <p>So the field of Ephron in Machpelah, which was facing Mamre, the field with the cave that was in it and all the trees that were in the field, throughout its whole area, was made over</p> <p>to Abraham as a possession in the presence of the sons of Heth, before all who went in at the gate of his city.</p> <p>After this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah facing Mamre (that is, Hebron) in the land of Canaan.</p> <p>The field and the cave that was in it were made over to Abraham as property for a burying place by the sons of Heth.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Gen 23:19; Gen 13:18
v4 — 1 Chr 29:15; Heb 11:9; Gen 17:8
v6 — Gen 24:35
v10 — Gen 34:20; Gen 34:24
v15 — Ezek 45:12
v16 — Zech 11:12; Jer 32:9
v17 — Gen 25:9; Gen 50:13

Chapter 24

Abraham sent his servant to Mesopotamia to find a wife for Isaac from among his kinsmen, not from the Canaanites. The servant prayed at the well and God guided him to Rebekah, who watered his camels; her family agreed to the match. Rebekah returned to Canaan and became Isaac's wife, and he loved her.

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| 1 <i>And Abraham was old, and well stricken in age: and the LORD had blessed Abraham in all things.</i> | Now Abraham was old, advanced in years. The LORD had blessed Abraham in all things. |
| 2 <i>And Abraham said unto his eldest servant of his house, that ruled over all that he had, Put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh:</i> | Abraham said to his oldest servant of his house, who had charge of all he had, 'Put your hand under my thigh, |
| 3 <i>And I will make thee swear by the LORD, the God of heaven, and the God of the earth, that thou shalt not take a wife unto my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I dwell:</i> | I will make You swear by the LORD, the God of heaven and the God of the earth, that You will not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I dwell, |
| 4 <i>But thou shalt go unto my country, and to my kindred, and take a wife unto my son Isaac.</i> | but will go to my country and to my family and take a wife for my son Isaac.' |
| 5 <i>And the servant said unto him, Peradventure the woman will not be willing to follow me unto this land: must I needs bring thy son again unto the land from whence thou camest?</i> | The servant said to him, 'Perhaps the woman will not be willing to follow me to this land. Must I then take your son back to the land from which you came?' |

- 6 *And Abraham said unto him, Beware thou that thou bring not my son thither again.* Abraham said to him, 'See to it that you do not take my son back there.
- 7 *The LORD God of heaven, which took me from my father's house, and from the land of my kindred, and which spake unto me, and that sware unto me, saying, Unto thy seed will I give this land; he shall send his angel before thee, and thou shalt take a wife unto my son from thence.* The LORD, the God of heaven, who took me from my father's house and from the land of my family, and who spoke to me and swore to me, saying, To Your seed I will give this land—He will send His angel before You, and You shall take a wife for my son from there.
- 8 *And if the woman will not be willing to follow thee, then thou shalt be clear from this my oath: only bring not my son thither again.* But if the woman is not willing to follow you, then you will be free from this oath of mine; only do not take my son back there.'
- 9 *And the servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham his master, and sware to him concerning that matter.* So the servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham his master and swore to him concerning this matter.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Mesopotamia* (mess-oh-puh-TAY-mee-uh) — "*Between the rivers*" Land between the Tigris and Euphrates; Abraham's ancestral homeland.

- 10 *And the servant took ten camels of the camels of his master, and departed; for all the goods of his master were in his hand: and he arose, and went to Mesopotamia, unto the city of Nahor.* Then the servant took ten of his master's camels and departed, taking all sorts of choice gifts from his master. He arose and went to Mesopotamia, to the city of Nahor.
- 11 *And he made his camels to kneel down without the city by a well of water at the time of the evening, even the time that women go out to draw water.* he made the camels kneel down outside the city by the well of water at the time of evening, the time when women go out to draw water.
- 12 *And he said, O LORD God of my master Abraham, I pray thee, send me good speed this day, and shew kindness unto my master Abraham.* He said, 'O LORD, God of my master Abraham, please grant me success today and show mercy to my master Abraham.

- 13 *Behold, I stand here by the well of water; and the daughters of the men of the city come out to draw water:* I stand here by the spring of water, and the daughters of the men of the city are coming out to draw water.
- 14 *And let it come to pass, that the damsel to whom I shall say, Let down thy pitcher, I pray thee, that I may drink; and she shall say, Drink, and I will give thy camels drink also: let the same be she that thou hast appointed for thy servant Isaac; and thereby shall I know that thou hast shewed kindness unto my master.* Let it be that the young woman to whom I shall say, Please let down your jar that I may drink, and who shall say, Drink. I will water your camels also—let her be the one you have appointed for your servant Isaac. By this I shall know that you have shown mercy to my master.'
- 15 *And it came to pass, before he had done speaking, that, behold, Rebekah came out, who was born to Bethuel, son of Milcah, the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, with her pitcher upon her shoulder.* Before he had finished speaking, Rebekah came out, who was born to Bethuel the son of Milcah, the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, with her water jar on her shoulder.
- 16 *And the damsel was very fair to look upon, a virgin, neither had any man known her: and she went down to the well, and filled her pitcher, and came up.* The young woman was very beautiful to look at, a virgin; no man had known her. She went down to the spring, filled her jar, and came up.
- 17 *And the servant ran to meet her, and said, Let me, I pray thee, drink a little water of thy pitcher.* Then the servant ran to meet her and said, 'Please give me a little water to drink from your jar.'
- 18 *And she said, Drink, my lord: and she hasted, and let down her pitcher upon her hand, and gave him drink.* She said, 'Drink, my lord.' And she quickly let down her jar upon her hand and gave him a drink.
- 19 *And when she had done giving him drink, she said, I will draw water for thy camels also, until they have done drinking.* When she had finished giving him a drink, she said, 'I will draw water for your camels also, until they have finished drinking.'

- 20 *And she hasted, and emptied her pitcher into the trough, and ran again unto the well to draw water, and drew for all his camels.* So she quickly emptied her jar into the trough and ran again to the well to draw water. She drew for all his camels.
- 21 *And the man wondering at her held his peace, to wit whether the LORD had made his journey prosperous or not.* The man gazed at her in silence to learn whether the LORD had prospered His journey or not.
- 22 *And it came to pass, as the camels had done drinking, that the man took a golden earring of half a shekel weight, and two bracelets for her hands of ten shekels weight of gold;* When the camels had finished drinking, the man took a gold ring weighing a half shekel, and two bracelets for her arms weighing ten gold shekels,
- 23 *And said, Whose daughter art thou? tell me, I pray thee: is there room in thy father's house for us to lodge in?* He He said, 'Whose daughter are you? Please tell me. Is there room in your father's house for us to spend the night?'
- 24 *And she said unto him, I am the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah, which she bare unto Nahor.* She said to him, 'I am the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah, whom she bore to Nahor.'
- 25 *She said moreover unto him, We have both straw and provender enough, and room to lodge in.* She added, 'We have plenty of both straw and fodder, and room to spend the night.'
- 26 *And the man bowed down his head, and worshipped the LORD.* The man bowed his head and worshiped the LORD,
- 27 *And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of my master Abraham, who hath not left destitute my master of his mercy and his truth: I being in the way, the LORD led me to the house of my master's brethren.* He said, 'Blessed be the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who has not forsaken his mercy and truth toward my master. As for me, the LORD has led me in the way to the house of my master's kinsmen.'
- 28 *And the damsel ran, and told them of her mother's house these things.* Then the young woman ran and told her mother's household about these things.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Laban (LAY-ban) — "White" Rebekah's brother. Later Jacob's father-in-law and the shrewd negotiator behind the Leah/Rachel marriage.*

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| 29 | <i>And Rebekah had a brother, and his name was Laban: and Laban ran out unto the man, unto the well.</i> | Rebekah had a brother whose name was Laban. Laban ran out to the man, to the spring. |
| 30 | <i>And it came to pass, when he saw the earring and bracelets upon his sister's hands, and when he heard the words of Rebekah his sister, saying, Thus spake the man unto me; that he came unto the man; and, behold, he stood by the camels at the well.</i> | As soon as he saw the ring and the bracelets on his sister's arms, and heard the words of Rebekah his sister, 'Thus the man spoke to me,' he went to the man. And he was standing by the camels at the spring. |
| 31 | <i>And he said, Come in, thou blessed of the LORD; wherefore standest thou without? for I have prepared the house, and room for the camels.</i> | He said, 'Come in, O blessed of the LORD. Why do You stand outside? For I have prepared the house and a place for the camels.' |
| 32 | <i>And the man came into the house: and he ungirded his camels, and gave straw and provender for the camels, and water to wash his feet, and the men's feet that were with him.</i> | So the man came into the house. He unloaded the camels, and gave straw and fodder to the camels, and there was water to wash his feet and the feet of the men who were with him. |
| 33 | <i>And there was set meat before him to eat: but he said, I will not eat, until I have told mine errand. And he said, Speak on.</i> | Then food was set before him to eat. But He said, 'I will not eat until I have told my errand.' He said, 'Speak on.' |
| 34 | <i>And he said, I am Abraham's servant.</i> | So he said, 'I am Abraham's servant.' |
| 35 | <i>And the LORD hath blessed my master greatly; and he is become great: and he hath given him flocks, and herds, and silver, and gold, and menservants, and maidservants, and camels, and asses.</i> | The LORD has greatly blessed my master. He has become great. He has given him flocks and herds, silver and gold, male and female servants, camels and donkeys. |

- 36 *And Sarah my master's wife bare a son to my master when she was old: and unto him hath he given all that he hath.* Sarah my master's wife bore a son to my master when she was old, and to him he has given all that he has.
- 37 *And my master made me swear, saying, Thou shalt not take a wife to my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I dwell:* My master made me swear, saying, You shall not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I dwell,
- 38 *But thou shalt go unto my father's house, and to my kindred, and take a wife unto my son.* but you shall go to my father's house and to my family and take a wife for my son.
- 39 *And I said unto my master, Peradventure the woman will not follow me.* I said to my master, Perhaps the woman will not follow me.
- 40 *And he said unto me, The LORD, before whom I walk, will send his angel with thee, and prosper thy way; and thou shalt take a wife for my son of my kindred, and of my father's house:* But He said to me, The LORD, before whom I walk, will send His angel with You and prosper Your way. You shall take a wife for my son from my family, from my father's house.
- 41 *Then shalt thou be clear from this my oath, when thou comest to my kindred; and if they give not thee one, thou shalt be clear from my oath.* Then You will be free from my oath, when You come to my family. And if they will not give her to You, You will be free from my oath.
- 42 *And I came this day unto the well, and said, O LORD God of my master Abraham, if now thou do prosper my way which I go:* I came today to the spring and said, O LORD, God of my master Abraham, if now you are prospering the way that I go,
- 43 *Behold, I stand by the well of water; and it shall come to pass, that when the virgin cometh forth to draw water, and I say to her, Give me, I pray thee, a little water of thy pitcher to drink;* I am standing by the spring of water. Let the virgin who comes out to draw water, to whom I shall say, Please give me a little water from Your jar to drink,

- 44 *And she say to me, Both drink thou, and I will also draw for thy camels: let the same be the woman whom the LORD hath appointed out for my master's son.* who will say to me, Drink. I will draw for Your camels also—let her be the woman whom the LORD has appointed for my master's son.
- 45 *And before I had done speaking in mine heart, behold, Rebekah came forth with her pitcher on her shoulder; and she went down unto the well, and drew water: and I said unto her, Let me drink, I pray thee.* Before I had finished speaking in my heart, Rebekah came out with her water jar on her shoulder. She went down to the spring and drew water. I said to her, Please let me drink.
- 46 *And she made haste, and let down her pitcher from her shoulder, and said, Drink, and I will give thy camels drink also: so I drank, and she made the camels drink also.* She quickly let down her jar from her shoulder and said, Drink. I will give your camels drink also. So I drank. She gave the camels drink also.
- 47 *And I asked her, and said, Whose daughter art thou? And she said, The daughter of Bethuel, Nahor's son, whom Milcah bare unto him: and I put the earring upon her face, and the bracelets upon her hands.* Then I asked her, Whose daughter are you? She said, The daughter of Bethuel, Nahor's son, whom Milcah bore to him. So I put the ring on her nose and the bracelets on her arms.
- 48 *And I bowed down my head, and worshipped the LORD, and blessed the LORD God of my master Abraham, which had led me in the right way to take my master's brother's daughter unto his son.* Then I bowed my head and worshiped the LORD and blessed the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who had led me by the right way to take the daughter of my master's kinsman for His son.
- 49 *And now if ye will deal kindly and truly with my master, tell me: and if not, tell me; that I may turn to the right hand, or to the left.* Now then, if You will show mercy and truth to my master, tell me. If not, tell me, that I may turn to the right hand or to the left.'

- 50 *Then Laban and Bethuel answered and said, The thing proceedeth from the LORD: we cannot speak unto thee bad or good.* Then Laban and Bethuel answered, 'The thing has come from the LORD; we cannot speak to You bad or good.
- 51 *Behold, Rebekah is before thee, take her, and go, and let her be thy master's son's wife, as the LORD hath spoken.* Rebekah is before you; take her and go, and let her be the wife of Your master's son, as the LORD has spoken.'
- 52 *And it came to pass, that, when Abraham's servant heard their words, he worshipped the LORD, bowing himself to the earth.* When Abraham's servant heard their words, he bowed himself to the earth before the LORD.
- 53 *And the servant brought forth jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment, and gave them to Rebekah: he gave also to her brother and to her mother precious things.* The servant brought out jewelry of silver and of gold, and garments, and gave them to Rebekah. He also gave to her brother and to her mother costly gifts.
- 54 *And they did eat and drink, he and the men that were with him, and tarried all night; and they rose up in the morning, and he said, Send me away unto my master.* he and the men who were with him ate and drank. They spent the night there. When they arose in the morning, he said, 'Send me away to my master.'
- 55 *And her brother and her mother said, Let the damsel abide with us a few days, at the least ten; after that she shall go.* Her brother and her mother said, 'Let the young woman remain with us a while, at least ten days; after that she may go.'
- 56 *And he said unto them, Hinder me not, seeing the LORD hath prospered my way; send me away that I may go to my master.* But He said to them, 'Do not delay me, since the LORD has prospered my way. Send me away that I may go to my master.'
- 57 *And they said, We will call the damsel, and enquire at her mouth.* They said, 'Let us call the young woman and ask her.'

- 58 *And they called Rebekah, and said unto her, Wilt thou go with this man? And she said, I will go.* They called Rebekah and said to her, 'Will you go with this man?' She said, 'I will go.'
- 59 *And they sent away Rebekah their sister, and her nurse, and Abraham's servant, and his men.* So they sent away Rebekah their sister and her nurse, and Abraham's servant and his men.
- 60 *And they blessed Rebekah, and said unto her, Thou art our sister, be thou the mother of thousands of millions, and let thy seed possess the gate of those which hate them.* They blessed Rebekah and said to her, 'Our sister, may you become the mother of thousands of ten thousands, and may your seed possess the gate of those who hate them.'
- 61 *And Rebekah arose, and her damsels, and they rode upon the camels, and followed the man: and the servant took Rebekah, and went his way.* Then Rebekah and her maidservants arose and rode on the camels and followed the man. So the servant took Rebekah and went his way.
- 62 *And Isaac came from the way of the well Lahairoi; for he dwelt in the south country.* Now Isaac had returned from Beer-lahai-roi, and was dwelling in the south.
- 63 *And Isaac went out to meditate in the field at the eventide: and he lifted up his eyes, and saw, and, behold, the camels were coming.* Isaac went out to meditate in the field toward evening. He lifted up his eyes and saw, and camels were coming.
- 64 *And Rebekah lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she lighted off the camel.* Rebekah lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she dismounted from the camel
- 65 *For she had said unto the servant, What man is this that walketh in the field to meet us? And the servant had said, It is my master: therefore she took a vail, and covered herself.* said to the servant, 'Who is that man walking in the field to meet us?' The servant said, 'It is my master.' So she took her veil and covered herself.
- 66 *And the servant told Isaac all things that he had done.* The servant told Isaac all the things that he had done.

- 67 *And Isaac brought her into his mother Sarah's tent, and took Rebekah, and she became his wife; and he loved her: and Isaac was comforted after his mother's death.* Then Isaac brought her into the tent of Sarah his mother and took Rebekah. She became his wife. He loved her. So Isaac was comforted after his mother's death.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Laban (*LAY-ban*) — Rebekah's brother and Jacob's uncle — Jacob worked fourteen years for him to marry his daughters; his name means 'white.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 112:1-3; Gal 3:9; Gen 13:2; Matt 6:33; Prov 10:22

v2 — Gen 47:29; Gen 39:4-6

v3 — Gen 26:34-35; 2 Cor 6:14-17; Neh 13:25; Gen 28:8; Deut 7:3-4

v7 — Ex 33:2; Ps 34:7; Heb 1:14; Gen 13:15; Ex 23:20-23

v14 — Judg 6:37; Judg 6:17

v15 — Gen 11:29; Isa 65:24; Gen 24:45

v26 — Gen 24:48; Gen 24:52; Ex 4:31

v27 — Gen 24:48; Gen 24:12; Ps 98:3; Ruth 4:14; Gen 32:10

v35 — Gen 13:2; Gen 24:1; Ps 107:38; Prov 10:22; Matt 6:33

v40 — Ex 23:20; Ps 16:8; Gen 5:24; Gen 17:1; Ex 33:2

v50 — Ps 118:23; Gen 31:24

v60 — Gen 22:17; Gen 17:16; Ruth 4:11-12; Gen 28:3; Gen 1:28

Chapter 25

Abraham married Keturah and had six more sons, but gave all he owned to Isaac; Abraham died at 175 and was buried at Machpelah. Ishmael's twelve sons are listed, and Ishmael died at 137. Rebekah conceived twins — Esau and Jacob; Esau sold his birthright to Jacob for a bowl of lentil stew.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Keturah* (*keh-TOO-rah*) — "Incense, perfumed" Abraham's wife after Sarah's death. Mother of six sons, including Midian.

- 1 *Then again Abraham took a wife, and her name was Keturah.* Abraham again took a wife. Her name was Keturah.

■ **NAME NOTE** Midian (MID-ee-an) — "Strife" Son of Abraham and Keturah. Ancestor of the Midianites (Moses's father-in-law Jethro was a Midianite priest). Zimran (ZIM-ran) — "Singer, celebrated" Son of Abraham and Keturah. Jokshan (JOCK-shan) — "Snarer, fowler" Son of Keturah. Medan (MEE-dan) — "Strife, contention" Son of Keturah.

- 2 *And she bare him Zimran, and Jokshan, and Medan, and Midian, and Ishbak, and Shuah.* She bore him Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah.
- 3 *And Jokshan begat Sheba, and Dedan. And the sons of Dedan were Asshurim, and Letushim, and Leummim.* Jokshan begat Sheba and Dedan. The sons of Dedan were Asshurim, Letushim, and Leummim.
- 4 *And the sons of Midian; Ephah, and Ephher, and Hanoch, and Abidah, and Eldaah. All these were the children of Keturah.* The sons of Midian were Ephah, Ephher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the children of Keturah.
- 5 *And Abraham gave all that he had unto Isaac.* Abraham gave all that he had to Isaac.
- 6 *But unto the sons of the concubines, which Abraham had, Abraham gave gifts, and sent them away from Isaac his son, while he yet lived, eastward, unto the east country.* But to the sons of his concubines Abraham gave gifts, and while he was still living he sent them away from his son Isaac, eastward to the east country.
- 7 *And these are the days of the years of Abraham's life which he lived, an hundred threescore and fifteen years.* These are the days of the years of Abraham's life, 175 years.
- 8 *Then Abraham gave up the ghost, and died in a good old age, an old man, and full of years; and was gathered to his people.* Abraham breathed his last and died in a good old age, an old man full of years, and was gathered to his people.

- 9 *And his sons Isaac and Ishmael buried him in the cave of Machpelah, in the field of Ephron the son of Zohar the Hittite, which is before Mamre;* Isaac and Ishmael his sons buried him in the cave of Machpelah, in the field of Ephron the son of Zohar the Hittite, facing Mamre,
- 10 *The field which Abraham purchased of the sons of Heth: there was Abraham buried, and Sarah his wife.* The field that Abraham purchased from the sons of Heth. There Abraham was buried, with Sarah his wife.
- 11 *And it came to pass after the death of Abraham, that God blessed his son Isaac; and Isaac dwelt by the well Lahairoi.* After the death of Abraham, God blessed Isaac his son, and Isaac lived at Beer-lahai-roi.
- 12 *Now these are the generations of Ishmael, Abraham's son, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's handmaid, bare unto Abraham:* These are the generations of Ishmael, Abraham's son, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's maidservant, bore to Abraham.

■ **NAME NOTE** Nebajoth (*neh-BAY-joth*) — "Heights, fruitfulness" Firstborn of Ishmael. Ancestor of the Nabataean Arabs. Kedar (*KEE-dar*) — "Dark, mighty" Second son of Ishmael; major Arab tribe of the northern desert.

- 13 *And these are the names of the sons of Ishmael, by their names, according to their generations: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebajoth; and Kedar, and Adbeel, and Mibsam,* These are the names of the sons of Ishmael, by their names, according to their generations: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebajoth, then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam,
- 14 *And Mishma, and Dumah, and Massa,* Mishma, Dumah, Massa,

■ **NAME NOTE** Tema (*TEE-mah*) — "Desert, south country" Son of Ishmael; gave his name to an oasis in northern Arabia.

- 15 *Hadar, and Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah:* Hadar, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah.
- 16 *These are the sons of Ishmael, and these are their names, by their towns, and by their castles; twelve princes according to their nations.* These are the sons of Ishmael, and these are their names, by their villages and by their encampments, twelve princes according to their tribes.

- 17 *And these are the years of the life of Ishmael, an hundred and thirty and seven years: and he gave up the ghost and died; and was gathered unto his people.* These are the years of the life of Ishmael: 137 years. He breathed his last and died, and was gathered to his people.
- 18 *And they dwelt from Havilah unto Shur, that is before Egypt, as thou goest toward Assyria: and he died in the presence of all his brethren.* They settled from Havilah to Shur, which is opposite Egypt in the direction of Assyria. He settled over against all his kinsmen.
- 19 *And these are the generations of Isaac, Abraham's son: Abraham begat Isaac:* These are the generations of Isaac, Abraham's son: Abraham begat Isaac,

■ **NAME NOTE** Padanaram (PAY-dan-AIR-am) — "Field of Aram" Region around Haran in northern Mesopotamia; home of Rebekah, Laban, and later Jacob's wives.

- 20 *And Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekah to wife, the daughter of Bethuel the Syrian of Padanaram, the sister to Laban the Syrian.* Isaac was 40 years old when he took Rebekah to be his wife, the daughter of Bethuel the Syrian of Padanaram, the sister of Laban the Syrian.
- 21 *And Isaac intreated the LORD for his wife, because she was barren: and the LORD was intreated of him, and Rebekah his wife conceived.* Isaac prayed to the LORD for his wife, because she was barren. And the LORD granted His prayer, and Rebekah his wife conceived.
- 22 *And the children struggled together within her; and she said, If it be so, why am I thus? And she went to enquire of the LORD.* The children struggled together within her. She said, 'If it is thus, why is this happening to me?' So she went to inquire of the LORD.
- 23 *And the LORD said unto her, Two nations are in thy womb, and two manner of people shall be separated from thy bowels; and the one people shall be stronger than the other people; and the elder shall serve the younger.* The LORD said to her, 'Two nations are in Your womb, and two peoples from within You shall be divided; the one shall be stronger than the other, the older shall serve the younger.'

- 24 *And when her days to be delivered were fulfilled, behold, there were twins in her womb.* When her days to be delivered were fulfilled, there were twins in her womb.

■ **NAME NOTE** Esau (EE-saw) — "Hairy" Firstborn twin of Isaac and Rebekah. Sold his birthright for stew. Also called Edom ("red"). Father of the Edomites.

- 25 *And the first came out red, all over like an hairy garment; and they called his name Esau.* The first came out red, all his body like a hairy cloak, so they called his name Esau.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jacob (JAY-kub) — "Heel-grabber, supplanter" Second-born twin who grasped Esau's heel at birth. Later renamed Israel. Father of the twelve tribes.

- 26 *And after that came his brother out, and his hand took hold on Esau's heel; and his name was called Jacob: and Isaac was threescore years old when she bare them.* Afterward his brother came out with his hand holding Esau's heel, so his name was called Jacob. Isaac was 60 years old when she bore them.
- 27 *And the boys grew: and Esau was a cunning hunter, a man of the field; and Jacob was a plain man, dwelling in tents.* The boys grew up. Esau was a skillful hunter, a man of the field, while Jacob was a quiet man, dwelling in tents.
- 28 *And Isaac loved Esau, because he did eat of his venison: but Rebekah loved Jacob.* Isaac loved Esau because he ate of his game, but Rebekah loved Jacob.
- 29 *And Jacob sod pottage: and Esau came from the field, and he was faint:* Once when Jacob was cooking stew, Esau came in from the field. He was exhausted.

■ **NAME NOTE** Edom (EE-dum) — "Red" Alternate name for Esau; also the nation descended from him, settled south of the Dead Sea.

- 30 *And Esau said to Jacob, Feed me, I pray thee, with that same red pottage; for I am faint: therefore was his name called Edom.* Esau said to Jacob, 'Let me have some of that red stew, for I am exhausted.' Therefore his name was called Edom.
- 31 *And Jacob said, Sell me this day thy birthright.* Jacob said, 'Sell me your birthright first.'

- 32 *And Esau said, Behold, I am at the point to die: and what profit shall this birthright do to me?* Esau said, 'I am about to die; of what use is a birthright to me?'
- 33 *And Jacob said, Swear to me this day; and he sware unto him: and he sold his birthright unto Jacob.* Jacob said, 'Swear to me first.' So he swore to him and sold his birthright to Jacob.
- 34 *Then Jacob gave Esau bread and pottage of lentiles; and he did eat and drink, and rose up, and went his way: thus Esau despised his birthright.* Then Jacob gave Esau bread and lentil stew. He ate and drank and rose and went his way. Thus Esau despised his birthright.

Words in this chapter:

pottage — A thick stew or soup — Esau sold his birthright for a bowl of red pottage (lentil stew).

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Padanaram (*PAD-an-AY-ram*) — The region in Mesopotamia (Syria) where Laban lived — meaning 'the plain of Aram'; Jacob went there to find a wife and worked fourteen years for Rachel.

Cross-References:

- v5** — Gen 24:36; Gal 3:29; Heb 1:2
v6 — Gen 21:14; Judg 6:3
v8 — Gen 35:28-29; Gen 15:15; 1 Chr 29:28; Job 5:26; Gen 47:8-9
v11 — Gen 22:17; Gen 16:14; Gen 17:19; Gen 24:62; Gen 12:2
v18 — Gen 16:12; Gen 20:1
v21 — Isa 58:9; 2 Chr 33:13; Ezra 8:23; Luke 1:13; Rom 9:10-12
v23 — Rom 9:10-13; Gen 27:40; Gen 27:29; 2 Sam 8:14; Mal 1:2-5
v26 — Hos 12:3; Gen 27:36
v27 — Heb 11:9; Gen 21:20; Gen 10:9; Gen 28:10-11; Gen 6:9
v29 — Prov 13:25; Isa 40:30-31
v32 — Mal 3:14; Job 22:17; Job 21:15; Job 34:9
v34 — Heb 12:16-17; Phil 3:18-19; Matt 26:15; Isa 22:13; 1 Cor 15:32

Chapter 26

A famine drove Isaac to Gerar, where the LORD appeared and confirmed the covenant promises made to Abraham. Isaac told the men of Gerar that Rebekah was his sister, but Abimelech discovered the deception; nonetheless Isaac prospered greatly and dug wells that the Philistines disputed. Abimelech sought a covenant of peace with Isaac at Beersheba, and Esau married Hittite wives who grieved his parents.

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| 1 | <i>And there was a famine in the land, beside the first famine that was in the days of Abraham. And Isaac went unto Abimelech king of the Philistines unto Gerar.</i> | There was a famine in the land, besides the former famine that was in the days of Abraham. And Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Philistines in Gerar. |
| 2 | <i>And the LORD appeared unto him, and said, Go not down into Egypt; dwell in the land which I shall tell thee of:</i> | The LORD appeared to Him and said, 'Do not go down to Egypt; dwell in the land of which I shall tell You. |
| 3 | <i>Sojourn in this land, and I will be with thee, and will bless thee; for unto thee, and unto thy seed, I will give all these countries, and I will perform the oath which I sware unto Abraham thy father;</i> | stay in this land. I will be with you and will bless you, for to you and to your seed I will give all these lands. I will establish the oath that I swore to Abraham your father. |
| 4 | <i>And I will make thy seed to multiply as the stars of heaven, and will give unto thy seed all these countries; and in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed;</i> | I will multiply your seed as the stars of the heavens and will give to your seed all these lands. And in your seed all the nations of the earth shall be blessed, |
| 5 | <i>Because that Abraham obeyed my voice, and kept my charge, my commandments, my statutes, and my laws.</i> | because Abraham obeyed my voice and kept my charge, my commandments, my statutes, and my laws.' |
| 6 | <i>And Isaac dwelt in Gerar:</i> | So Isaac lived in Gerar. |

- 7 *And the men of the place asked him of his wife; and he said, She is my sister: for he feared to say, She is my wife; lest, said he, the men of the place should kill me for Rebekah; because she was fair to look upon.* When the men of the place asked him about his wife, he said, 'She is my sister,' for he feared to say, 'She is my wife,' thinking, 'The men of the place might kill me because of Rebekah, for she is beautiful to look at.'
- 8 *And it came to pass, when he had been there a long time, that Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out at a window, and saw, and, behold, Isaac was sporting with Rebekah his wife.* When he had been there a long time, Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out of a window and saw Isaac caressing Rebekah his wife.
- 9 *And Abimelech called Isaac, and said, Behold, of a surety she is thy wife: and how saidst thou, She is my sister? And Isaac said unto him, Because I said, Lest I die for her.* So Abimelech called Isaac and said, 'she is surely your wife. How then could you say, She is my sister?' Isaac said to him, 'Because I thought, Lest I die because of her.'
- 10 *And Abimelech said, What is this thou hast done unto us? one of the people might lightly have lien with thy wife, and thou shouldest have brought guiltiness upon us.* Abimelech said, 'What is this you have done to us? One of the people might easily have lain with your wife, and you would have brought guilt upon us.'
- 11 *And Abimelech charged all his people, saying, He that toucheth this man or his wife shall surely be put to death.* So Abimelech commanded all the people, saying, 'Whoever touches this man or his wife shall surely be put to death.'
- 12 *Then Isaac sowed in that land, and received in the same year an hundredfold: and the LORD blessed him.* Isaac sowed in that land and reaped in the same year a hundredfold. The LORD blessed Him,
- 13 *And the man waxed great, and went forward, and grew until he became very great:* The man became rich, and gained more and more until he became very wealthy.

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| <p>14 <i>For he had possession of flocks, and possession of herds, and great store of servants: and the Philistines envied him.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For all the wells which his father's servants had digged in the days of Abraham his father, the Philistines had stopped them, and filled them with earth.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And Abimelech said unto Isaac, Go from us; for thou art much mightier than we.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And Isaac departed thence, and pitched his tent in the valley of Gerar, and dwelt there.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And Isaac digged again the wells of water, which they had digged in the days of Abraham his father; for the Philistines had stopped them after the death of Abraham: and he called their names after the names by which his father had called them.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Isaac's servants digged in the valley, and found there a well of springing water.</i></p> | <p>He had possessions of flocks and herds and many servants, so that the Philistines envied him.</p> <p>Now the Philistines had stopped up and filled with earth all the wells that his father's servants had dug in the days of Abraham his father.</p> <p>Abimelech said to Isaac, 'Go away from us, for you are much mightier than we.'</p> <p>So Isaac departed from there and pitched his tent in the Valley of Gerar and lived there.</p> <p>Isaac dug again the wells of water that had been dug in the days of Abraham his father, which the Philistines had stopped after the death of Abraham. He gave them the names that his father had called them.</p> <p>But when Isaac's servants dug in the valley and found there a well of fresh water,</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Esek (EE-sek) — "Contention, quarrel" Well Isaac's servants dug where the herdsmen of Gerar quarreled with them.

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| <p>20 <i>And the herdmen of Gerar did strive with Isaac's herdmen, saying, The water is ours: and he called the name of the well Esek; because they strove with him.</i></p> | <p>The herdsmen of Gerar quarreled with Isaac's herdsmen, saying, 'The water is ours.' So he called the name of the well Esek, because they quarreled with him.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Sitnah (SIT-nuh) — "Hostility, accusation" Second disputed well. The name is the root of "Satan" — the accuser.

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| 21 <i>And they digged another well, and strove for that also: and he called the name of it Sitnah.</i> | Then they dug another well. They quarreled over that also, so he called its name Sitnah. |
| 22 <i>And he removed from thence, and digged another well; and for that they strove not: and he called the name of it Rehoboth; and he said, For now the LORD hath made room for us, and we shall be fruitful in the land.</i> | He moved from there and dug another well. They did not quarrel over it. So He called its name Rehoboth, saying, 'For now the LORD has made room for us. We shall be fruitful in the land.' |
| 23 <i>And he went up from thence to Beersheba.</i> | From there He went up to Beersheba. |
| 24 <i>And the LORD appeared unto him the same night, and said, I am the God of Abraham thy father: fear not, for I am with thee, and will bless thee, and multiply thy seed for my servant Abraham's sake.</i> | The LORD appeared to Him the same night and said, 'I am the God of Abraham your father. Do not fear, for I am with you and will bless You and multiply Your seed for my servant Abraham's sake.' |
| 25 <i>And he builded an altar there, and called upon the name of the LORD, and pitched his tent there: and there Isaac's servants digged a well.</i> | So He built an altar there and called on the name of the LORD and pitched his tent there, and there Isaac's servants dug a well. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Ahuzzath (uh-HUZ-ath) — "Possession, holder" Friend of Abimelech who accompanied him to make covenant with Isaac.

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| 26 <i>Then Abimelech went to him from Gerar, and Ahuzzath one of his friends, and Phichol the chief captain of his army.</i> | Then Abimelech went to Him from Gerar with Ahuzzath His friend and Phichol the commander of His army. |
| 27 <i>And Isaac said unto them, Wherefore come ye to me, seeing ye hate me, and have sent me away from you?</i> | Isaac said to them, 'Why have you come to me, seeing you hate me and have sent me away from you?' |

- 28 *And they said, We saw certainly that the LORD was with thee: and we said, Let there be now an oath betwixt us, even betwixt us and thee, and let us make a covenant with thee;* They said, 'We see plainly that the LORD has been with You. So we said, Let there be an oath between us, between You and us, and let us make a covenant with You,
- 29 *That thou wilt do us no hurt, as we have not touched thee, and as we have done unto thee nothing but good, and have sent thee away in peace: thou art now the blessed of the LORD.* that You will do us no harm, just as we have not touched You and have done to You nothing but good and have sent You away in peace. You are now the blessed of the LORD.'
- 30 *And he made them a feast, and they did eat and drink.* So He made them a feast. They ate and drank.
- 31 *And they rose up betimes in the morning, and sware one to another: and Isaac sent them away, and they departed from him in peace.* In the morning they rose early and exchanged oaths. Then Isaac sent them on their way. They departed from him in peace.
- 32 *And it came to pass the same day, that Isaac's servants came, and told him concerning the well which they had digged, and said unto him, We have found water.* That same day Isaac's servants came and told him about the well that they had dug, and said to him, 'We have found water.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Shebah (SHEE-bah) — "Oath, seven" Name Isaac gave to the well at Beersheba after the oath with Abimelech.

- 33 *And he called it Shebah: therefore the name of the city is Beersheba unto this day.* He called it Shebah; therefore the name of the city is Beersheba to this day.

■ **NAME NOTE** Judith (JOO-dith) — "Praised, Jewess" Hittite wife of Esau; grieved Isaac and Rebekah. Beeri (beh-EE-rye) — "Man of the well" Hittite father of Esau's wife Judith. Bashemath (BASH-uh-math) — "Fragrance, sweet-smelling" Another Hittite wife of Esau, daughter of Elon. Elon (EE-lon) — "Oak, strong" Hittite father of Esau's wife Bashemath.

- 34 *And Esau was forty years old when he took to wife Judith the daughter of Beeri the Hittite, and Bashemath the daughter of Elon the Hittite:* When Esau was 40 years old, he took Judith the daughter of Beeri the Hittite as his wife, and Bashemath the daughter of Elon the Hittite.

- 35 *Which were a grief of mind unto Isaac* They made life bitter for Isaac and
and to Rebekah. Rebekah.
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Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Rebekah (*reh-BEK-ah*) — Isaac's wife, brought from Mesopotamia — mother of Jacob and Esau; her name may mean 'to tie' or 'to bind.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 12:10; Gen 25:11; Gen 21:22-32
- v2 — Gen 12:7; Gen 18:1; Gen 17:1; Gen 12:1; Ps 37:3
- v3 — Gen 28:15; Ps 105:9; Gen 13:15; Gen 12:7; Gen 22:16-18
- v4 — Acts 3:25; Gen 22:17-18; Gen 15:5; Gal 3:8; Gen 13:16
- v5 — Matt 7:24; Gen 22:18; Gen 22:16; Jas 2:21; Ps 112:1-2
- v7 — Prov 29:25; Gen 12:13; Gen 20:2; Gen 24:16
- v12 — Mark 4:8; 2 Cor 9:10-11; Zech 8:12; Gen 26:3; Gen 24:1
- v22 — Gen 17:6; Ex 1:7; Ps 118:5
- v24 — Gen 15:1; Ex 3:6; Acts 7:32; Isa 43:1-2; Gen 17:7
- v25 — Ps 116:17; Gen 13:18
- v29 — Gen 24:31; Gen 21:22; Gen 12:2; Gen 22:17; Ps 115:15
- v34 — Gen 36:2; Gen 36:13; Ex 34:16

Chapter 27

Isaac, old and blind, sent Esau to hunt game so he could bless him, but Rebekah and Jacob deceived Isaac with goat skins and savory food, and Jacob received the firstborn's blessing. When Esau returned and the deception was discovered, Isaac trembled and Esau wept bitterly, receiving only a lesser blessing. Esau resolved to kill Jacob, so Rebekah urged Jacob to flee to her brother Laban in Haran.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, that when Isaac was old, and his eyes were dim, so that he could not see, he called Esau his eldest son, and said unto him, My son: and he said unto him, Behold, here am I.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And he said, Behold now, I am old, I know not the day of my death:</i></p> <p>3 <i>Now therefore take, I pray thee, thy weapons, thy quiver and thy bow, and go out to the field, and take me some venison;</i></p> <p>4 <i>And make me savoury meat, such as I love, and bring it to me, that I may eat; that my soul may bless thee before I die.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And Rebekah heard when Isaac spake to Esau his son. And Esau went to the field to hunt for venison, and to bring it.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And Rebekah spake unto Jacob her son, saying, Behold, I heard thy father speak unto Esau thy brother, saying,</i></p> <p>7 <i>Bring me venison, and make me savoury meat, that I may eat, and bless thee before the LORD before my death.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Now therefore, my son, obey my voice according to that which I command thee.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Go now to the flock, and fetch me from thence two good kids of the goats; and I will make them savoury meat for thy father, such as he loveth:</i></p> | <p>When Isaac was old and his eyes were dim so that he could not see, he called Esau his older son and said to him, 'My son.' And he said to him, 'Here I am.'</p> <p>He said, ' I am now old; I do not know the day of my death.</p> <p>Now then, take your weapons, your quiver and your bow, and go out to the field and hunt game for me.</p> <p>prepare for me savory food, such as I love, and bring it to me so that I may eat, that my soul may bless you before I die.'</p> <p>Rebekah was listening when Isaac spoke to his son Esau. So when Esau went to the field to hunt for game and bring it,</p> <p>Rebekah said to her son Jacob, ' I heard your father speak to your brother Esau, saying,</p> <p>Bring me game and prepare for me savory food, that I may eat it and bless You before the LORD before my death.</p> <p>Now therefore, my son, obey my voice in what I command You.</p> <p>Go to the flock and bring me from there two good young goats, so that I may prepare from them savory food for Your father, such as He loves.</p> |
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- 10 *And thou shalt bring it to thy father, that he may eat, and that he may bless thee before his death.* you shall bring it to Your father to eat, that He may bless You before His death.'
- 11 *And Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, Behold, Esau my brother is a hairy man, and I am a smooth man:* But Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, ' my brother Esau is a hairy man. I am a smooth man.
- 12 *My father peradventure will feel me, and I shall seem to him as a deceiver; and I shall bring a curse upon me, and not a blessing.* Perhaps my father will feel me. I shall seem to him as a deceiver and bring a curse upon myself and not a blessing.'
- 13 *And his mother said unto him, Upon me be thy curse, my son: only obey my voice, and go fetch me them.* His mother said to him, 'Upon me be your curse, my son; only obey my voice and go, bring them to me.'
- 14 *And he went, and fetched, and brought them to his mother: and his mother made savoury meat, such as his father loved.* So he went and took them and brought them to his mother. His mother prepared savory food, such as his father loved.
- 15 *And Rebekah took goodly raiment of her eldest son Esau, which were with her in the house, and put them upon Jacob her younger son:* Then Rebekah took the best garments of Esau her older son, which were with her in the house, and put them on Jacob her younger son.
- 16 *And she put the skins of the kids of the goats upon his hands, and upon the smooth of his neck:* she put the skins of the young goats on his hands and on the smooth part of his neck.
- 17 *And she gave the savoury meat and the bread, which she had prepared, into the hand of her son Jacob.* Then she put the savory food and the bread which she had prepared into the hand of her son Jacob.
- 18 *And he came unto his father, and said, My father: and he said, Here am I; who art thou, my son?* So he went to his father and said, 'My father.' And he said, 'Here I am. Who are you, my son?'

- 19 *And Jacob said unto his father, I am Esau thy firstborn; I have done according as thou badest me: arise, I pray thee, sit and eat of my venison, that thy soul may bless me.* Jacob said to his father, 'I am Esau your firstborn. I have done as you told me. Please arise, sit and eat of my game, that your soul may bless me.'
- 20 *And Isaac said unto his son, How is it that thou hast found it so quickly, my son? And he said, Because the LORD thy God brought it to me.* Isaac said to his son, 'How is it that you have found it so quickly, my son?' He said, 'Because the LORD Your God granted me success.'
- 21 *And Isaac said unto Jacob, Come near, I pray thee, that I may feel thee, my son, whether thou be my very son Esau or not.* Then Isaac said to Jacob, 'Please come near, that I may feel you, my son, to know whether you are really my son Esau or not.'
- 22 *And Jacob went near unto Isaac his father; and he felt him, and said, The voice is Jacob's voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau.* So Jacob went near to Isaac his father, who felt him and said, 'The voice is Jacob's voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau.'
- 23 *And he discerned him not, because his hands were hairy, as his brother Esau's hands: so he blessed him.* He did not recognize him, because his hands were hairy like his brother Esau's hands. So he blessed him.
- 24 *And he said, Art thou my very son Esau? And he said, I am.* He said, 'Are you really my son Esau?' He answered, 'I am.'
- 25 *And he said, Bring it near to me, and I will eat of my son's venison, that my soul may bless thee. And he brought it near to him, and he did eat: and he brought him wine, and he drank.* Then he said, 'Bring it near to me, that I may eat of my son's game and my soul may bless you.' So he brought it near to him. He ate. He brought him wine. He drank.
- 26 *And his father Isaac said unto him, Come near now, and kiss me, my son.* Then his father Isaac said to him, 'Come near and kiss me, my son.'

- 27 *And he came near, and kissed him: and he smelled the smell of his raiment, and blessed him, and said, See, the smell of my son is as the smell of a field which the LORD hath blessed:* So He came near and kissed Him. And He smelled the smell of His garments and blessed Him, and said, 'See, the smell of my son is like the smell of a field that the LORD has blessed.
- 28 *Therefore God give thee of the dew of heaven, and the fatness of the earth, and plenty of corn and wine:* May God give You of the dew of heaven and of the fatness of the earth, and plenty of grain and wine.
- 29 *Let people serve thee, and nations bow down to thee: be lord over thy brethren, and let thy mother's sons bow down to thee: cursed be every one that curseth thee, and blessed be he that blesseth thee.* Let peoples serve You, and nations bow down to You. Be lord over Your brothers, and may Your mother's sons bow down to You. Cursed be everyone who curses You, and blessed be everyone who blesses You.'
- 30 *And it came to pass, as soon as Isaac had made an end of blessing Jacob, and Jacob was yet scarce gone out from the presence of Isaac his father, that Esau his brother came in from his hunting.* As soon as Isaac had finished blessing Jacob, when Jacob had scarcely gone out from the presence of Isaac his father, Esau his brother came in from his hunting.
- 31 *And he also had made savoury meat, and brought it unto his father, and said unto his father, Let my father arise, and eat of his son's venison, that thy soul may bless me.* He also prepared savory food and brought it to his father. And he said to his father, 'Let my father arise and eat of his son's game, that your soul may bless me.'
- 32 *And Isaac his father said unto him, Who art thou? And he said, I am thy son, thy firstborn Esau.* His father Isaac said to him, 'Who are you?' He answered, 'I am your son, your firstborn, Esau.'
- 33 *And Isaac trembled very exceedingly, and said, Who? where is he that hath taken venison, and brought it me, and I have eaten of all before thou camest, and have blessed him? yea, and he shall be blessed.* Then Isaac trembled violently and said, 'Who then was it that hunted game and brought it to me, so that I ate of it all before you came, and have blessed him? Yes, and he shall be blessed.'

- 34 *And when Esau heard the words of his father, he cried with a great and exceeding bitter cry, and said unto his father, Bless me, even me also, O my father.* When Esau heard the words of his father, he cried out with an exceedingly great and bitter cry and said to his father, 'Bless me, even me also, O my father!'
- 35 *And he said, Thy brother came with subtilty, and hath taken away thy blessing.* But he said, 'Your brother came with deceit and has taken away your blessing.'
- 36 *And he said, Is not he rightly named Jacob? for he hath supplanted me these two times: he took away my birthright; and, behold, now he hath taken away my blessing. And he said, Hast thou not reserved a blessing for me?* Esau said, 'Is he not rightly named Jacob? For he has supplanted me these two times. He took away my birthright, and now he has taken away my blessing.' Then he said, 'Have you not reserved a blessing for me?'
- 37 *And Isaac answered and said unto Esau, Behold, I have made him thy lord, and all his brethren have I given to him for servants; and with corn and wine have I sustained him: and what shall I do now unto thee, my son?* Isaac answered and said to Esau, 'I have made him lord over you. All his brothers I have given him for servants, and with grain and wine I have sustained him. What then can I do for you, my son?'
- 38 *And Esau said unto his father, Hast thou but one blessing, my father? bless me, even me also, O my father. And Esau lifted up his voice, and wept.* Esau said to his father, 'Have you but one blessing, my father? Bless me, even me also, O my father.' And Esau lifted up his voice and wept.
- 39 *And Isaac his father answered and said unto him, Behold, thy dwelling shall be the fatness of the earth, and of the dew of heaven from above;* Then Isaac his father answered and said to him, 'Your dwelling shall be of the fatness of the earth, and of the dew of heaven from above.
- 40 *And by thy sword shalt thou live, and shalt serve thy brother; and it shall come to pass when thou shalt have the dominion, that thou shalt break his yoke from off thy neck.* By your sword you shall live, and you shall serve your brother. But when you have the dominion, you shall break his yoke from off your neck.'

- 41 *And Esau hated Jacob because of the blessing wherewith his father blessed him: and Esau said in his heart, The days of mourning for my father are at hand; then will I slay my brother Jacob.* Now Esau hated Jacob because of the blessing with which his father had blessed him. And Esau said in his heart, 'The days of mourning for my father are near; then I will kill my brother Jacob.'
- 42 *And these words of Esau her elder son were told to Rebekah: and she sent and called Jacob her younger son, and said unto him, Behold, thy brother Esau, as touching thee, doth comfort himself, purposing to kill thee.* But the words of Esau her older son were told to Rebekah. So she sent and called Jacob her younger son and said to him, ' your brother Esau is comforting himself concerning you by planning to kill you.
- 43 *Now therefore, my son, obey my voice; and arise, flee thou to Laban my brother to Haran;* Now therefore, my son, obey my voice. Arise, flee to Laban my brother in Haran,
- 44 *And tarry with him a few days, until thy brother's fury turn away;* stay with him a few days, until your brother's fury turns away,
- 45 *Until thy brother's anger turn away from thee, and he forget that which thou hast done to him: then I will send, and fetch thee from thence: why should I be deprived also of you both in one day?* until your brother's anger turns away from you and he forgets what you have done to him. Then I will send and bring you from there. Why should I be bereaved of you both in one day?'
- 46 *And Rebekah said to Isaac, I am weary of my life because of the daughters of Heth: if Jacob take a wife of the daughters of Heth, such as these which are of the daughters of the land, what good shall my life do me?* Then Rebekah said to Isaac, 'I am weary of my life because of the daughters of Heth. If Jacob takes a wife of the daughters of Heth, like these, from the daughters of the land, what good shall my life be to me?'

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Laban (*LAY-ban*) — Rebekah's brother and Jacob's uncle — Jacob worked fourteen years for him to marry his daughters; his name means 'white.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 48:10; 1 Sam 3:2
- v4 — Heb 11:20; Gen 48:9; Gen 27:25; Gen 49:28; Luke 24:51
- v13 — Matt 27:25; 1 Sam 25:24
- v15 — Gen 27:27
- v23 — Gen 27:16; Heb 11:20
- v27 — Heb 6:7; Ps 65:10; Heb 11:20; Gen 26:12; Hos 14:6-7
- v28 — Deut 33:28; Deut 33:13; Ps 133:3; Hos 14:5-7; Deut 7:13
- v29 — Num 24:9; Gen 12:3; Isa 49:23; Rom 9:12; Gen 9:25-26
- v34 — Heb 12:17; Prov 1:31
- v39 — Gen 27:28; Heb 11:20
- v40 — 2 Kgs 8:20-22; Gen 25:23; 2 Chr 25:11-12
- v41 — 1 John 3:12-15; Gen 37:4; Gen 50:3-4

Chapter 28

Isaac blessed Jacob and sent him to Padanaram to take a wife from Laban's daughters; Esau, seeing this, married a daughter of Ishmael. On the way, Jacob slept at a certain place and dreamed of a ladder reaching to heaven with angels ascending and descending; the LORD stood above it and renewed the covenant promises. Jacob named the place Bethel and vowed that the LORD would be his God.

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| 1 | <i>And Isaac called Jacob, and blessed him, and charged him, and said unto him, Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan.</i> | Then Isaac called Jacob and blessed him and commanded him, 'You shall not take a wife from the daughters of Canaan. |
| 2 | <i>Arise, go to Padanaram, to the house of Bethuel thy mother's father; and take thee a wife from thence of the daughters of Laban thy mother's brother.</i> | Arise, go to Padanaram to the house of Bethuel your mother's father, and take as your wife from there one of the daughters of Laban your mother's brother. |

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| 3 | <i>And God Almighty bless thee, and make thee fruitful, and multiply thee, that thou mayest be a multitude of people;</i> | God Almighty bless you and make you fruitful and multiply you, that you may become a company of peoples. |
| 4 | <i>And give thee the blessing of Abraham, to thee, and to thy seed with thee; that thou mayest inherit the land wherein thou art a stranger, which God gave unto Abraham.</i> | May he give the blessing of Abraham to you and to your seed with you, that you may take possession of the land of your sojournings, which God gave to Abraham.' |
| 5 | <i>And Isaac sent away Jacob: and he went to Padanaram unto Laban, son of Bethuel the Syrian, the brother of Rebekah, Jacob's and Esau's mother.</i> | So Isaac sent Jacob away. He went to Padanaram, to Laban, the son of Bethuel the Syrian, the brother of Rebekah, Jacob's and Esau's mother. |
| 6 | <i>When Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob, and sent him away to Padanaram, to take him a wife from thence; and that as he blessed him he gave him a charge, saying, Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan;</i> | Now when Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob and sent him away to Padanaram to take a wife from there, and that as he blessed him he commanded him, 'You shall not take a wife from the daughters of Canaan,' |
| 7 | <i>And that Jacob obeyed his father and his mother, and was gone to Padanaram;</i> | that Jacob had obeyed his father and his mother and had gone to Padanaram, |
| 8 | <i>And Esau seeing that the daughters of Canaan pleased not Isaac his father;</i> | Esau saw that the daughters of Canaan did not please Isaac his father. |
- **NAME NOTE** Mahalath (MAH-huh-lath) — "Sickness, lyre" Daughter of Ishmael; Esau's third wife, taken to please his father.
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| 9 | <i>Then went Esau unto Ishmael, and took unto the wives which he had Mahalath the daughter of Ishmael Abraham's son, the sister of Nebajoth, to be his wife.</i> | So Esau went to Ishmael and took Mahalath the daughter of Ishmael, Abraham's son, the sister of Nebajoth, in addition to the wives he had, to be his wife. |
| 10 | <i>And Jacob went out from Beersheba, and went toward Haran.</i> | Jacob left Beersheba and went toward Haran. |

- 11 *And he lighted upon a certain place, and tarried there all night, because the sun was set; and he took of the stones of that place, and put them for his pillows, and lay down in that place to sleep.* He came to a certain place and stayed there that night, because the sun had set. Taking one of the stones of the place, he put it under his head and lay down in that place to sleep.
- 12 *And he dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven: and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it.* He dreamed, and there was a ladder set up on the earth, and its top reached to heaven. And the angels of God were ascending and descending on it.
- 13 *And, behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, I am the LORD God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: the land whereon thou liest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed;* The LORD stood above it and said, 'I am the LORD, the God of Abraham your father and the God of Isaac. The land on which you lie I will give to you and to Your seed.
- 14 *And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth, and thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and in thee and in thy seed shall all the families of the earth be blessed.* Your seed shall be like the dust of the earth, and You shall spread abroad to the west and to the east and to the north and to the south. And in You and in Your seed shall all the families of the earth be blessed.
- 15 *And, behold, I am with thee, and will keep thee in all places whither thou goest, and will bring thee again into this land; for I will not leave thee, until I have done that which I have spoken to thee of.* I am with You and will keep You wherever You go, and will bring You back to this land. For I will not leave You until I have done what I have promised You.'
- 16 *And Jacob awaked out of his sleep, and he said, Surely the LORD is in this place; and I knew it not.* Then Jacob awoke from his sleep and said, 'Surely the LORD is in this place. I did not know it.'
- 17 *And he was afraid, and said, How dreadful is this place! this is none other but the house of God, and this is the gate of heaven.* He was afraid and said, 'How awesome is this place! This is none other than the house of God, and this is the gate of heaven.'

- 18 *And Jacob rose up early in the morning, and took the stone that he had put for his pillows, and set it up for a pillar, and poured oil upon the top of it.* So early in the morning Jacob took the stone that he had put under his head and set it up for a pillar and poured oil on the top of it.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Luz (LUHZ) — "Almond tree" Original Canaanite name of Bethel before Jacob renamed it.*

- 19 *And he called the name of that place Bethel: but the name of that city was called Luz at the first.* He called the name of that place Bethel, but the name of the city was Luz at first.
- 20 *And Jacob vowed a vow, saying, If God will be with me, and will keep me in this way that I go, and will give me bread to eat, and raiment to put on,* Then Jacob made a vow, saying, 'If God will be with me and will keep me in this way that I go and will give me bread to eat and clothing to wear,
- 21 *so that I come again to my father's house in peace; then shall the LORD be my God:* so that I come again to my father's house in peace, then the LORD shall be my God,
- 22 *And this stone, which I have set for a pillar, shall be God's house: and of all that thou shalt give me I will surely give the tenth unto thee.* this stone, which I have set up for a pillar, shall be God's house. And of all that You give me I will give a full tenth to You.'

Words in this chapter:

Mahalath (*MAH-hah-lath*) — A Psalm title of uncertain meaning — possibly a tune name, or related to 'sickness' (a lament tune).

Cross-References:

v3 — Gen 48:3; Gen 35:11; Gen 22:17-18; Gen 1:28; Gen 43:14
v4 — Gal 3:14; Gen 12:7; Eph 1:3
v12 — John 1:51; Num 12:6; Gen 32:1-2; Job 33:15-16; Gen 15:1
v13 — Gen 13:15; Gen 35:12; Gen 48:3; Gen 26:24; Gen 35:1
v14 — Gen 12:3; Gen 18:18; Gen 22:18; Acts 3:25; Gen 13:16
v15 — Josh 1:5; Isa 41:10; Jer 1:19; Deut 31:6; Gen 26:24
v17 — 1 Tim 3:15; Gen 35:1-13; Eccl 5:1; Ex 3:6; 2 Chr 5:14
v18 — Gen 35:14; Gen 31:45; Gen 31:13; Lev 8:10-12
v19 — Gen 48:3; Hos 12:4-5; Gen 35:1; Judg 1:22-26; Hos 4:15

v20 — 1 Tim 6:8; 2 Sam 15:8; Gen 31:13; John 1:16; Ps 66:13

v21 — Judg 11:31; Deut 26:17; Ex 15:2

v22 — Gen 35:7; Gen 14:20; Deut 14:22-23; Lev 27:30-33; Gen 35:1

Chapter 29

Jacob arrived in Haran, met Rachel at the well, and agreed to serve Laban seven years for her hand. On the wedding night Laban substituted Leah for Rachel; Jacob discovered the deception in the morning and agreed to serve seven more years for Rachel. The LORD opened Leah's womb because she was unloved, and she bore Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah.

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| 1 <i>Then Jacob went on his journey, and came into the land of the people of the east.</i> | Then Jacob went on his journey and came to the land of the people of the east. |
| 2 <i>And he looked, and behold a well in the field, and, lo, there were three flocks of sheep lying by it; for out of that well they watered the flocks: and a great stone was upon the well's mouth.</i> | As he looked, he saw a well in the field, and three flocks of sheep lying beside it, for from that well they watered the flocks. The stone on the well's mouth was large. |
| 3 <i>And thither were all the flocks gathered: and they rolled the stone from the well's mouth, and watered the sheep, and put the stone again upon the well's mouth in his place.</i> | When all the flocks were gathered there, the shepherds would roll the stone from the mouth of the well and water the sheep, and put the stone back in its place on the mouth of the well. |
| 4 <i>And Jacob said unto them, My brethren, whence be ye? And they said, Of Haran are we.</i> | Jacob said to them, 'My brothers, where do you come from?' They said, 'We are from Haran.' |
| 5 <i>And he said unto them, Know ye Laban the son of Nahor? And they said, We know him.</i> | He said to them, 'Do you know Laban the son of Nahor?' They said, 'We know him.' |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Rachel (RAY-chul)* — "Ewe, female sheep" Younger daughter of Laban; Jacob's beloved wife. Mother of Joseph and Benjamin. Died giving birth to Benjamin.

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| 6 <i>And he said unto them, Is he well? And they said, He is well: and, behold, Rachel his daughter cometh with the sheep.</i> | He said to them, 'Is it well with him?' They said, 'It is well. Rachel his daughter is coming with the sheep.' |
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- 7 *And he said, Lo, it is yet high day, neither is it time that the cattle should be gathered together: water ye the sheep, and go and feed them.* He said, 'it is still high day; it is not time for the livestock to be gathered together. Water the sheep and go, pasture them.'
- 8 *And they said, We cannot, until all the flocks be gathered together, and till they roll the stone from the well's mouth; then we water the sheep.* But they said, 'We cannot until all the flocks are gathered together and the stone is rolled from the mouth of the well; then we water the sheep.'
- 9 *And while he yet spake with them, Rachel came with her father's sheep: for she kept them.* While he was still speaking with them, Rachel came with her father's sheep, for she kept them.
- 10 *And it came to pass, when Jacob saw Rachel the daughter of Laban his mother's brother, and the sheep of Laban his mother's brother, that Jacob went near, and rolled the stone from the well's mouth, and watered the flock of Laban his mother's brother.* When Jacob saw Rachel the daughter of Laban his mother's brother and the sheep of Laban his mother's brother, Jacob came near and rolled the stone from the mouth of the well and watered the flock of Laban his mother's brother.
- 11 *And Jacob kissed Rachel, and lifted up his voice, and wept.* Then Jacob kissed Rachel and wept aloud.
- 12 *And Jacob told Rachel that he was her father's brother, and that he was Rebekah's son: and she ran and told her father.* Jacob told Rachel that he was her father's kinsman and that he was Rebekah's son. She ran and told her father.
- 13 *And it came to pass, when Laban heard the tidings of Jacob his sister's son, that he ran to meet him, and embraced him, and kissed him, and brought him to his house. And he told Laban all these things.* As soon as Laban heard the news about Jacob his sister's son, he ran to meet him and embraced him and kissed him and brought him to his house. Jacob told Laban all these things,
- 14 *And Laban said to him, Surely thou art my bone and my flesh. And he abode with him the space of a month.* Laban said to him, 'Surely you are my bone and my flesh.' And he stayed with him a month.

- 15 *And Laban said unto Jacob, Because thou art my brother, shouldest thou therefore serve me for nought? tell me, what shall thy wages be?* Then Laban said to Jacob, 'Because you are my kinsman, should you therefore serve me for nothing? Tell me, what shall your wages be?'

■ NAME NOTE Leah (LEE-uh) — "Weary, cow" Older daughter of Laban. Given to Jacob by Laban's deception. Mother of six of the twelve tribes.

- 16 *And Laban had two daughters: the name of the elder was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.* Now Laban had two daughters: the name of the older was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.
- 17 *Leah was tender eyed; but Rachel was beautiful and well favoured.* Leah's eyes were weak, but Rachel was beautiful in form and appearance.
- 18 *And Jacob loved Rachel; and said, I will serve thee seven years for Rachel thy younger daughter.* Jacob loved Rachel. He said, 'I will serve you seven years for your younger daughter Rachel.'
- 19 *And Laban said, It is better that I give her to thee, than that I should give her to another man: abide with me.* Laban said, 'It is better that I give her to you than that I should give her to any other man; stay with me.'
- 20 *And Jacob served seven years for Rachel; and they seemed unto him but a few days, for the love he had to her.* So Jacob served seven years for Rachel. They seemed to him but a few days because of the love he had for her.
- 21 *And Jacob said unto Laban, Give me my wife, for my days are fulfilled, that I may go in unto her.* Then Jacob said to Laban, 'Give me my wife, for my time is completed, that I may go in to her.'
- 22 *And Laban gathered together all the men of the place, and made a feast.* So Laban gathered together all the men of the place and made a feast.
- 23 *And it came to pass in the evening, that he took Leah his daughter, and brought her to him; and he went in unto her.* But in the evening he took his daughter Leah and brought her to Jacob. He went in to her.

■ NAME NOTE Zilpah (ZIL-pah) — "Trickling, fragrant dropping" Leah's maidservant, given to Jacob as a wife. Mother of Gad and Asher.

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| 24 <i>And Laban gave unto his daughter Leah Zilpah his maid for an handmaid.</i> | Laban gave his female servant Zilpah to his daughter Leah to be her servant. |
| 25 <i>And it came to pass, that in the morning, behold, it was Leah: and he said to Laban, What is this thou hast done unto me? did not I serve with thee for Rachel? wherefore then hast thou beguiled me?</i> | In the morning, it was Leah! And Jacob said to Laban, 'What is this you have done to me? Did I not serve with you for Rachel? Why then have you deceived me?' |
| 26 <i>And Laban said, It must not be so done in our country, to give the younger before the firstborn.</i> | Laban said, 'It is not so done in our country, to give the younger before the firstborn. |
| 27 <i>Fulfil her week, and we will give thee this also for the service which thou shalt serve with me yet seven other years.</i> | Complete the week of this one. We will give you the other also in return for serving me another seven years.' |
| 28 <i>And Jacob did so, and fulfilled her week: and he gave him Rachel his daughter to wife also.</i> | Jacob did so, and completed her week. Then Laban gave him his daughter Rachel to be his wife. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Bilhah (BIL-hah) — "Troubled, timid" Rachel's maidservant, given to Jacob as a wife. Mother of Dan and Naphtali.

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| 29 <i>And Laban gave to Rachel his daughter Bilhah his handmaid to be her maid.</i> | Laban gave his female servant Bilhah to his daughter Rachel to be her servant. |
| 30 <i>And he went in also unto Rachel, and he loved also Rachel more than Leah, and served with him yet seven other years.</i> | So Jacob went in to Rachel also. He loved Rachel more than Leah, and served Laban for another seven years. |
| 31 <i>And when the LORD saw that Leah was hated, he opened her womb: but Rachel was barren.</i> | When the LORD saw that Leah was hated, he opened her womb, but Rachel was barren. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Reuben (ROO-ben) — "Behold, a son" Jacob's firstborn, son of Leah. Lost his birthright blessing later due to sin with Bilhah.

- 32 *And Leah conceived, and bare a son, and she called his name Reuben: for she said, Surely the LORD hath looked upon my affliction; now therefore my husband will love me.* Leah conceived and bore a son. She called his name Reuben, for she said, 'Because the LORD has looked upon my affliction; surely now my husband will love me.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Simeon (SIM-ee-on) — "Heard" Second son of Jacob and Leah. Later a tribe of Israel.

- 33 *And she conceived again, and bare a son; and said, Because the LORD hath heard that I was hated, he hath therefore given me this son also: and she called his name Simeon.* She conceived again and bore a son, and said, 'Because the LORD has heard that I am hated, He has given me this son also.' And she called His name Simeon.

■ **NAME NOTE** Levi (LEE-vye) — "Joined, attached" Third son of Jacob and Leah. Ancestor of the priestly tribe (Moses and Aaron were Levites).

- 34 *And she conceived again, and bare a son; and said, Now this time will my husband be joined unto me, because I have born him three sons: therefore was his name called Levi.* Again she conceived and bore a son, and said, 'Now this time my husband will be joined to me, because I have borne Him three sons.' Therefore His name was called Levi.

■ **NAME NOTE** Judah (JOO-duh) — "Praise" Fourth son of Jacob and Leah. Ancestor of King David and of Christ. His name gives us "Jew."

- 35 *And she conceived again, and bare a son: and she said, Now will I praise the LORD: therefore she called his name Judah; and left bearing.* She conceived again and bore a son, and said, 'This time I will praise the LORD.' Therefore she called His name Judah. Then she stopped bearing.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (JOO-dah) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Leah (LEE-ah) — Jacob's first wife, Laban's older daughter — mother of six of the twelve tribal ancestors and of Dinah; her name may mean 'weary.'

Levi (LEE-vy) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Rachel (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 6:3; Judg 6:33; Hos 12:12
- v10 — Ex 2:17
- v11 — Gen 33:4; Gen 45:14-15; Gen 45:2; Gen 43:30
- v12 — Gen 24:28; Gen 13:8
- v14 — 2 Sam 19:12-13; Gen 2:23; Judg 9:2; 2 Sam 5:1
- v16 — Ruth 4:11; Gen 49:31
- v18 — Hos 12:12; Ex 22:16-17
- v20 — 1 Cor 13:7; Hos 12:12; Eph 5:2; Song 8:6-7
- v25 — Matt 7:2; Prov 11:31
- v31 — 1 Sam 2:21; Deut 21:15; 1 Sam 1:5; Ps 127:3; Matt 10:37
- v32 — Deut 26:7; Ex 3:7; Ex 4:31; Luke 1:25; Gen 49:3-4
- v35 — 1 Chr 5:2; Gen 49:8-12; Matt 1:2; Deut 33:7; Gen 35:26

Chapter 30

Rachel, barren and envious of Leah, gave her maid Bilhah to Jacob; Bilhah bore Dan and Naphtali, and Leah's maid Zilpah bore Gad and Asher. Leah bore Issachar, Zebulun, and a daughter Dinah; then God remembered Rachel, and she bore Joseph. Jacob bargained with Laban over wages, breeding the speckled and spotted livestock for himself, and grew exceedingly prosperous.

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| 1 | <i>And when Rachel saw that she bare Jacob no children, Rachel envied her sister; and said unto Jacob, Give me children, or else I die.</i> | When Rachel saw that she bore Jacob no children, she envied her sister. And she said to Jacob, 'Give me children, or I shall die!' |
| 2 | <i>And Jacob's anger was kindled against Rachel: and he said, Am I in God's stead, who hath withheld from thee the fruit of the womb?</i> | Jacob's anger was kindled against Rachel. He said, 'Am I in the place of God, Who has withheld from you the fruit of the womb?' |
| 3 | <i>And she said, Behold my maid Bilhah, go in unto her; and she shall bear upon my knees, that I may also have children by her.</i> | Then she said, 'Here is my servant Bilhah; go in to her, so that she may give birth on my knees. I too may have children through her.' |

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| 4 | <i>And she gave him Bilhah her handmaid to wife: and Jacob went in unto her.</i> | So she gave him her servant Bilhah as a wife, and Jacob went in to her. |
| 5 | <i>And Bilhah conceived, and bare Jacob a son.</i> | Bilhah conceived and bore Jacob a son. |
| 6 | <i>And Rachel said, God hath judged me, and hath also heard my voice, and hath given me a son: therefore called she his name Dan.</i> | Then Rachel said, 'God has judged me, and has also heard my voice and given me a son.' Therefore she called His name Dan. |
| 7 | <i>And Bilhah Rachel's maid conceived again, and bare Jacob a second son.</i> | Rachel's servant Bilhah conceived again and bore Jacob a second son. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Naphtali (NAF-tuh-lye) — "My struggle, my wrestling" Second son of Bilhah. Named for the "wrestling" between the sisters. Later a tribe in northern Israel.

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| 8 | <i>And Rachel said, With great wrestlings have I wrestled with my sister, and I have prevailed: and she called his name Naphtali.</i> | Then Rachel said, 'With mighty wrestlings I have wrestled with my sister and have prevailed.' So she called his name Naphtali. |
| 9 | <i>When Leah saw that she had left bearing, she took Zilpah her maid, and gave her Jacob to wife.</i> | When Leah saw that she had stopped bearing, she took her servant Zilpah and gave her to Jacob as a wife. |
| 10 | <i>And Zilpah Leah's maid bare Jacob a son.</i> | Then Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a son. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Gad (GAD) — "Good fortune, troop" First son of Zilpah (as Leah's surrogate). Later a tribe east of the Jordan.

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| 11 | <i>And Leah said, A troop cometh: and she called his name Gad.</i> | Leah said, 'Good fortune has come!' So she called his name Gad. |
| 12 | <i>And Zilpah Leah's maid bare Jacob a second son.</i> | Leah's servant Zilpah bore Jacob a second son. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Asher (ASH-er) — "Happy, blessed" Second son of Zilpah. Later a tribe on the Mediterranean coast.

- 13 *And Leah said, Happy am I, for the daughters will call me blessed: and she called his name Asher.* Leah said, 'Happy am I! For women have called me happy.' So she called his name Asher.
- 14 *And Reuben went in the days of wheat harvest, and found mandrakes in the field, and brought them unto his mother Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, Give me, I pray thee, of thy son's mandrakes.* In the days of wheat harvest Reuben went and found mandrakes in the field and brought them to his mother Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, 'Please give me some of your son's mandrakes.'
- 15 *And she said unto her, Is it a small matter that thou hast taken my husband? and wouldest thou take away my son's mandrakes also? And Rachel said, Therefore he shall lie with thee to night for thy son's mandrakes.* But she said to her, 'Is it a small matter that you have taken away my husband? Would you take away my son's mandrakes also?' Rachel said, 'Then he may lie with you tonight in exchange for your son's mandrakes.'
- 16 *And Jacob came out of the field in the evening, and Leah went out to meet him, and said, Thou must come in unto me; for surely I have hired thee with my son's mandrakes. And he lay with her that night.* When Jacob came from the field in the evening, Leah went out to meet him and said, 'You must come in to me, for I have hired you with my son's mandrakes.' So he lay with her that night.
- 17 *And God hearkened unto Leah, and she conceived, and bare Jacob the fifth son.* God listened to Leah. She conceived and bore Jacob a fifth son.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Issachar (IS-uh-kar) — "Hired, reward" Ninth son of Jacob, fifth of Leah. Later a tribe in the Jezreel valley.*

- 18 *And Leah said, God hath given me my hire, because I have given my maiden to my husband: and she called his name Issachar.* Leah said, 'God has given me my wages because I gave my servant to my husband.' So she called His name Issachar.
- 19 *And Leah conceived again, and bare Jacob the sixth son.* Leah conceived again and bore Jacob a sixth son.

■ **NAME NOTE** Zebulun (ZEB-yoo-lun) — "Dwelling, honor" Tenth son of Jacob, sixth of Leah. Later a tribe in northern Israel.

- 20 *And Leah said, God hath endued me with a good dowry; now will my husband dwell with me, because I have born him six sons: and she called his name Zebulun.* Then Leah said, 'God has endowed me with a good endowment; now my husband will honor me, because I have borne Him six sons.' So she called His name Zebulun.

■ **NAME NOTE** Dinah (DIE-nuh) — "Judgment, vindication" Only named daughter of Jacob, born to Leah. Her story unfolds in Genesis 34.

- 21 *And afterwards she bare a daughter, and called her name Dinah.* Afterward she bore a daughter and called her name Dinah.
- 22 *And God remembered Rachel, and God hearkened to her, and opened her womb.* Then God remembered Rachel. God listened to her and opened her womb.
- 23 *And she conceived, and bare a son; and said, God hath taken away my reproach:* She conceived and bore a son and said, 'God has taken away my reproach.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Joseph (JO-zef) — "May he add" Eleventh son of Jacob, firstborn of Rachel. Sold into slavery by his brothers, rose to rule Egypt. His story dominates the end of Genesis.

- 24 *And she called his name Joseph; and said, The LORD shall add to me another son.* she called His name Joseph, saying, 'May the LORD add to me another son!'
- 25 *And it came to pass, when Rachel had born Joseph, that Jacob said unto Laban, Send me away, that I may go unto mine own place, and to my country.* When Rachel had borne Joseph, Jacob said to Laban, 'Send me away, that I may go to my own home and country.
- 26 *Give me my wives and my children, for whom I have served thee, and let me go: for thou knowest my service which I have done thee.* Give me my wives and my children for whom I have served you, and let me go, for you know the service that I have given you.'

- 27 *And Laban said unto him, I pray thee, if I have found favour in thine eyes, tarry: for I have learned by experience that the LORD hath blessed me for thy sake.* But Laban said to Him, 'If I have found favor in Your sight, please stay, for I have learned by experience that the LORD has blessed me because of You.
- 28 *And he said, Appoint me thy wages, and I will give it.* Name Your wages. I will give it.'
- 29 *And he said unto him, Thou knowest how I have served thee, and how thy cattle was with me.* Jacob said to him, 'You yourself know how I have served you, and how your livestock has fared with me.
- 30 *For it was little which thou hadst before I came, and it is now increased unto a multitude; and the LORD hath blessed thee since my coming: and now when shall I provide for mine own house also?* For You had little before I came. It has increased abundantly. The LORD has blessed You wherever I turned. But now when shall I provide for my own household also?'
- 31 *And he said, What shall I give thee? And Jacob said, Thou shalt not give me any thing: if thou wilt do this thing for me, I will again feed and keep thy flock.* He said, 'What shall I give you?' Jacob said, 'You shall not give me anything. If you will do this for me, I will again pasture your flock and keep it.
- 32 *I will pass through all thy flock to day, removing from thence all the speckled and spotted cattle, and all the brown cattle among the sheep, and the spotted and speckled among the goats: and of such shall be my hire.* Let me pass through all your flock today, removing from it every speckled and spotted sheep and every black lamb, and the spotted and speckled among the goats. They shall be my wages.
- 33 *So shall my righteousness answer for me in time to come, when it shall come for my hire before thy face: every one that is not speckled and spotted among the goats, and brown among the sheep, that shall be counted stolen with me.* So my honesty will answer for me later, when you come to look into my wages with you. Every one that is not speckled and spotted among the goats and black among the lambs, if found with me, shall be counted stolen.'

- 34 *And Laban said, Behold, I would it might be according to thy word.* Laban said, 'Good! Let it be as you have said.'
- 35 *And he removed that day the he goats that were ringstraked and spotted, and all the she goats that were speckled and spotted, and every one that had some white in it, and all the brown among the sheep, and gave them into the hand of his sons.* But that day Laban removed the male goats that were striped and spotted. All the female goats that were speckled and spotted, every one that had white on it, and every black lamb, and put them in the charge of his sons.
- 36 *And he set three days' journey betwixt himself and Jacob: and Jacob fed the rest of Laban's flocks.* he set a distance of three days' journey between himself and Jacob, and Jacob pastured the rest of Laban's flock.
- 37 *And Jacob took him rods of green poplar, and of the hazel and chesnut tree; and pilled white strakes in them, and made the white appear which was in the rods.* Then Jacob took fresh sticks of poplar and almond and plane trees, and peeled white streaks in them, exposing the white of the sticks.
- 38 *And he set the rods which he had pilled before the flocks in the gutters in the watering troughs when the flocks came to drink, that they should conceive when they came to drink.* He set the sticks that he had peeled in front of the flocks in the troughs, that is, the watering places, where the flocks came to drink. And since they bred when they came to drink,
- 39 *And the flocks conceived before the rods, and brought forth cattle ringstraked, speckled, and spotted.* the flocks bred in front of the sticks and so the flocks brought forth striped, speckled, and spotted.
- 40 *And Jacob did separate the lambs, and set the faces of the flocks toward the ringstraked, and all the brown in the flock of Laban; and he put his own flocks by themselves, and put them not unto Laban's cattle.* Jacob separated the lambs and set the faces of the flocks toward the striped and all the black in the flock of Laban. He put his own droves apart and did not put them with Laban's flock.

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| <p>41 <i>And it came to pass, whensoever the stronger cattle did conceive, that Jacob laid the rods before the eyes of the cattle in the gutters, that they might conceive among the rods.</i></p> <p>42 <i>But when the cattle were feeble, he put them not in: so the feebler were Laban's, and the stronger Jacob's.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And the man increased exceedingly, and had much cattle, and maidservants, and menservants, and camels, and asses.</i></p> | <p>Whenever the stronger of the flock were breeding, Jacob would lay the sticks in the troughs before the eyes of the flock, that they might breed among the sticks,</p> <p>but for the feebler of the flock he would not lay them there. So the feebler would be Laban's, and the stronger Jacob's.</p> <p>Thus the man increased greatly and had large flocks, female servants and male servants, and camels and donkeys.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Job 5:2; Gen 29:31; Gen 37:11; 1 Cor 3:3; Prov 14:30

v2 — Gen 16:2; Ps 127:3; 2 Kgs 5:7

v6 — Lam 3:59; Ps 35:24; Ps 43:1

v11 — Gen 49:19

v22 — Gen 29:31; Ps 113:9; Gen 8:1; Gen 25:21; 1 Sam 1:19-20

v23 — Luke 1:25; Gen 29:31; Luke 1:27

v24 — Gen 49:22-26; Gen 35:24

v26 — Hos 12:12; Gen 29:30

v27 — Acts 7:10; Ruth 2:13; Isa 61:9; Gen 26:24; Gen 12:3

v29 — Gen 31:6; Gen 31:38-40

v30 — 1 Tim 5:8; 2 Cor 12:14

v43 — Gen 26:13-14; Gen 30:30; Gen 24:35; Gen 13:2

Chapter 31

Jacob fled from Laban with his wives, children, and livestock after God told him to return to his homeland; Rachel secretly stole her father's household gods. Laban pursued and overtook Jacob in the hill country of Gilead, but God warned Laban in a dream not to harm him. They confronted each other, searched the tents without finding the idols, and made a covenant at a heap of stones before parting in peace.

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| <p>1 <i>And he heard the words of Laban's sons, saying, Jacob hath taken away all that was our father's; and of that which was our father's hath he gotten all this glory.</i></p> | <p>Jacob heard the words of Laban's sons, saying, 'Jacob has taken away all that was our father's, and from what was our father's he has gained all this wealth.'</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And Jacob beheld the countenance of Laban, and, behold, it was not toward him as before.</i></p> | <p>Jacob saw the face of Laban. It was not toward him as before.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And the LORD said unto Jacob, Return unto the land of thy fathers, and to thy kindred; and I will be with thee.</i></p> | <p>Then the LORD said to Jacob, 'Return to the land of your fathers and to your family. I will be with you.'</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah to the field unto his flock,</i></p> | <p>So Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah into the field to his flock</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And said unto them, I see your father's countenance, that it is not toward me as before; but the God of my father hath been with me.</i></p> | <p>said to them, 'I see that your father's face is not toward me as before. But the God of my father has been with me.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And ye know that with all my power I have served your father.</i></p> | <p>You know that I have served your father with all my strength,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And your father hath deceived me, and changed my wages ten times; but God suffered him not to hurt me.</i></p> | <p>yet your father has cheated me and changed my wages ten times. But God did not permit Him to harm me.</p> |

- 8 *If he said thus, The speckled shall be thy wages; then all the cattle bare speckled: and if he said thus, The ringstraked shall be thy hire; then bare all the cattle ringstraked.* If he said, The speckled shall be your wages, then all the flock bore speckled. If he said, The striped shall be your wages, then all the flock bore striped.
- 9 *Thus God hath taken away the cattle of your father, and given them to me.* Thus God has taken away the livestock of your father and given them to me.
- 10 *And it came to pass at the time that the cattle conceived, that I lifted up mine eyes, and saw in a dream, and, behold, the rams which leaped upon the cattle were ringstraked, speckled, and grisled.* In the breeding season of the flock I lifted up my eyes and saw in a dream that the rams leaping on the flock were striped, speckled, and mottled.
- 11 *And the angel of God spake unto me in a dream, saying, Jacob: And I said, Here am I.* Then the angel of God said to me in the dream, 'Jacob,' and I said, 'Here I am.'
- 12 *And he said, Lift up now thine eyes, and see, all the rams which leap upon the cattle are ringstraked, speckled, and grisled: for I have seen all that Laban doeth unto thee.* He said, 'Lift up your eyes and see, all the rams leaping on the flock are striped, speckled, and mottled, for I have seen all that Laban is doing to you.
- 13 *I am the God of Bethel, where thou anointedst the pillar, and where thou vowedst a vow unto me: now arise, get thee out from this land, and return unto the land of thy kindred.* I am the God of Bethel, where you anointed a pillar and made a vow to me. Now arise, go out from this land and return to the land of your family.'
- 14 *And Rachel and Leah answered and said unto him, Is there yet any portion or inheritance for us in our father's house?* Then Rachel and Leah answered and said to him, 'Is there any portion or inheritance left for us in our father's house?
- 15 *Are we not counted of him strangers? for he hath sold us, and hath quite devoured also our money.* Are we not regarded by him as foreigners? For he has sold us. He has also entirely consumed our money.

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| 16 | <i>For all the riches which God hath taken from our father, that is ours, and our children's: now then, whatsoever God hath said unto thee, do.</i> | All the wealth that God has taken away from our father belongs to us and to our children. Now then, whatever God has said to you, do.' |
| 17 | <i>Then Jacob rose up, and set his sons and his wives upon camels;</i> | So Jacob arose and set his sons and his wives on camels, |
| 18 | <i>And he carried away all his cattle, and all his goods which he had gotten, the cattle of his getting, which he had gotten in Padanaram, for to go to Isaac his father in the land of Canaan.</i> | He drove away all his livestock and all his property that he had acquired, the livestock he had gained in Padanaram, to go to the land of Canaan, to his father Isaac. |
| 19 | <i>And Laban went to shear his sheep: and Rachel had stolen the images that were her father's.</i> | Laban had gone to shear his sheep, and Rachel stole her father's household gods. |
| 20 | <i>And Jacob stole away unawares to Laban the Syrian, in that he told him not that he fled.</i> | Jacob deceived Laban the Syrian, by not telling him that he was fleeing. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Gilead (GIL-ee-ad) — "Heap of witness, rocky region" Hill country east of the Jordan where Jacob and Laban made their covenant. Later a tribal territory.

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| 21 | <i>So he fled with all that he had; and he rose up, and passed over the river, and set his face toward the mount Gilead.</i> | So he fled with all that he had. He arose and crossed the Euphrates and set his face toward the hill country of Gilead. |
| 22 | <i>And it was told Laban on the third day that Jacob was fled.</i> | On the third day Laban was told that Jacob had fled. |
| 23 | <i>And he took his brethren with him, and pursued after him seven days' journey; and they overtook him in the mount Gilead.</i> | He took his kinsmen with him and pursued Jacob for seven days and overtook him in the hill country of Gilead. |
| 24 | <i>And God came to Laban the Syrian in a dream by night, and said unto him, Take heed that thou speak not to Jacob either good or bad.</i> | But God came to Laban the Syrian in a dream by night and said to Him, 'Be careful that you speak to Jacob neither good nor bad.' |

- 25 *Then Laban overtook Jacob. Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the mount: and Laban with his brethren pitched in the mount of Gilead.* Laban overtook Jacob. Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the hill country, and Laban with his kinsmen pitched tents in the hill country of Gilead.
- 26 *And Laban said to Jacob, What hast thou done, that thou hast stolen away unawares to me, and carried away my daughters, as captives taken with the sword?* Laban said to Jacob, 'What have you done, that you have deceived me and driven away my daughters like captives taken with the sword?
- 27 *Wherefore didst thou flee away secretly, and steal away from me; and didst not tell me, that I might have sent thee away with mirth, and with songs, with tabret, and with harp?* Why did you flee secretly and deceive me, and did not tell me, so that I might have sent you away with joy and songs, with tambourine and lyre?
- 28 *And hast not suffered me to kiss my sons and my daughters? thou hast now done foolishly in so doing.* why did you not permit me to kiss my sons and my daughters farewell? Now you have done foolishly.
- 29 *It is in the power of my hand to do you hurt: but the God of your father spake unto me yesternight, saying, Take thou heed that thou speak not to Jacob either good or bad.* It is in my power to do you harm. But the God of your father spoke to me last night, saying, Be careful that you speak to Jacob neither good nor bad.
- 30 *And now, though thou wouldest needs be gone, because thou sore longedst after thy father's house, yet wherefore hast thou stolen my gods?* now you have gone away because you longed greatly for your father's house, but why did you steal my gods?'
- 31 *And Jacob answered and said to Laban, Because I was afraid: for I said, Peradventure thou wouldest take by force thy daughters from me.* Jacob answered and said to Laban, 'Because I was afraid, for I thought that you would take your daughters from me by force.
- 32 *With whomsoever thou findest thy gods, let him not live: before our brethren discern thou what is thine with me, and take it to thee. For Jacob knew not that Rachel had stolen them.* Anyone with whom you find your gods shall not live. In the presence of our kinsmen, point out what I have that is yours, and take it.' Now Jacob did not know that Rachel had stolen them.

- 33 *And Laban went into Jacob's tent, and into Leah's tent, and into the two maidservants' tents; but he found them not. Then went he out of Leah's tent, and entered into Rachel's tent.* So Laban went into Jacob's tent, and into Leah's tent, and into the tent of the two female servants. But he did not find them. And he went out of Leah's tent and entered Rachel's.
- 34 *Now Rachel had taken the images, and put them in the camel's furniture, and sat upon them. And Laban searched all the tent, but found them not.* Now Rachel had taken the household gods and put them in the camel's saddle and sat on them. Laban felt all about the tent but did not find them.
- 35 *And she said to her father, Let it not displease my lord that I cannot rise up before thee; for the custom of women is upon me. And he searched, but found not the images.* she said to her father, 'Let not my lord be angry that I cannot rise before you, for the way of women is upon me.' So he searched but did not find the household gods.
- 36 *And Jacob was wroth, and chode with Laban: and Jacob answered and said to Laban, What is my trespass? what is my sin, that thou hast so hotly pursued after me?* Then Jacob became angry and argued with Laban. Jacob said to Laban, 'What is my offense? What is my sin, that you have hotly pursued me?
- 37 *Whereas thou hast searched all my stuff, what hast thou found of all thy household stuff? set it here before my brethren and thy brethren, that they may judge betwixt us both.* For you have felt through all my goods; what have you found of all your household goods? Set it here before my kinsmen and your kinsmen, that they may decide between us two.
- 38 *This twenty years have I been with thee; thy ewes and thy she goats have not cast their young, and the rams of thy flock have I not eaten.* These twenty years I have been with you; your ewes and your female goats have not miscarried. I have not eaten the rams of your flocks.
- 39 *That which was torn of beasts I brought not unto thee; I bare the loss of it; of my hand didst thou require it, whether stolen by day, or stolen by night.* What was torn by wild beasts I did not bring to you; I bore the loss of it myself. From my hand you required it, whether stolen by day or stolen by night.

- 40 *Thus I was; in the day the drought consumed me, and the frost by night; and my sleep departed from mine eyes.* There I was: by day the heat consumed me, and the cold by night, and my sleep fled from my eyes.
- 41 *Thus have I been twenty years in thy house; I served thee fourteen years for thy two daughters, and six years for thy cattle: and thou hast changed my wages ten times.* These twenty years I have been in your house. I served you fourteen years for your two daughters and six years for your flock, and you have changed my wages ten times.
- 42 *Except the God of my father, the God of Abraham, and the fear of Isaac, had been with me, surely thou hadst sent me away now empty. God hath seen mine affliction and the labour of my hands, and rebuked thee yesternight.* If the God of my father, the God of Abraham and the Fear of Isaac, had not been with me, surely now you would have sent me away empty-handed. God saw my affliction and the labor of my hands and rebuked you last night.'
- 43 *And Laban answered and said unto Jacob, These daughters are my daughters, and these children are my children, and these cattle are my cattle, and all that thou seest is mine: and what can I do this day unto these my daughters, or unto their children which they have born?* Then Laban answered and said to Jacob, 'The daughters are my daughters, the children are my children, the flocks are my flocks. All that you see is mine. But what can I do this day for these my daughters or for their children whom they have borne?
- 44 *Now therefore come thou, let us make a covenant, I and thou; and let it be for a witness between me and thee.* Come now, let us make a covenant, you and I. And let it be a witness between you and me.'
- 45 *And Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a pillar.* So Jacob took a stone and set it up as a pillar.
- 46 *And Jacob said unto his brethren, Gather stones; and they took stones, and made an heap: and they did eat there upon the heap.* Jacob said to his kinsmen, 'Gather stones.' And they took stones and made a heap. They ate there by the heap.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jegarsahadutha (JEH-gar-sah-ha-DOO-tha) — "Heap of witness (Aramaic)" Laban's Aramaic name for the stone heap; Jacob called it Galeed in Hebrew — same meaning, different language. Galeed (GAL-ee-ed) — "Heap of witness (Hebrew)" Jacob's Hebrew name for the pillar of stones between him and Laban. Root of the name Gilead.

- 47 *And Laban called it Jegarsahadutha: but Jacob called it Galeed.* Laban called it Jegar-sahadutha, but Jacob called it Galeed.
- 48 *And Laban said, This heap is a witness between me and thee this day. Therefore was the name of it called Galeed;* Laban said, 'This heap is a witness between you and me today.' Therefore he named it Galeed,

■ **NAME NOTE** Mizpah (MIZ-pah) — "Watchtower" The "Mizpah benediction" — "The LORD watch between you and me" — comes from this place and moment.

- 49 *And Mizpah; for he said, The LORD watch between me and thee, when we are absent one from another.* also Mizpah, for He said, 'The LORD watch between You and me, when we are out of one another's sight.
- 50 *If thou shalt afflict my daughters, or if thou shalt take other wives beside my daughters, no man is with us; see, God is witness betwixt me and thee.* If You mistreat my daughters, or if You take wives besides my daughters, although no one is with us, see, God is witness between You and me.'
- 51 *And Laban said to Jacob, Behold this heap, and behold this pillar, which I have cast betwixt me and thee;* Then Laban said to Jacob, 'See this heap and the pillar, which I have set between you and me.
- 52 *This heap be witness, and this pillar be witness, that I will not pass over this heap to thee, and that thou shalt not pass over this heap and this pillar unto me, for harm.* This heap is a witness, and the pillar is a witness, that I will not pass over this heap to you, and you will not pass over this heap and this pillar to me, for harm.
- 53 *The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge betwixt us. And Jacob sware by the fear of his father Isaac.* The God of Abraham and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge between us.' So Jacob swore by the Fear of his father Isaac.

- 54

Then Jacob offered sacrifice upon the mount, and called his brethren to eat bread: and they did eat bread, and tarried all night in the mount.

Then Jacob offered a sacrifice in the hill country and called his kinsmen to eat bread. They ate bread and spent the night in the hill country.
- 55

And early in the morning Laban rose up, and kissed his sons and his daughters, and blessed them: and Laban departed, and returned unto his place.

Early in the morning Laban arose and kissed his sons and his daughters and blessed them. Then Laban departed and returned to his home.

Words in this chapter:

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Dan 3:19; Gen 4:5; 1 Sam 18:9-11
- v3 — Gen 28:15; Heb 13:5; Gen 32:9; Ps 50:15; Gen 31:13
- v5 — Gen 31:2-3; Gen 31:42; Gen 31:53; Gen 48:15
- v9 — Gen 31:1; Gen 31:16
- v13 — Gen 31:3; Gen 32:9; Gen 28:12-22
- v19 — 1 Sam 19:13; Gen 31:30; Hos 3:4; Gen 35:2; Ezek 21:21
- v24 — Gen 24:50; Gen 20:3; Gen 31:29; Gen 31:42; Num 24:13
- v29 — Gen 31:53; Gen 31:42
- v32 — Gen 31:23; Gen 31:30; Gen 44:9-12; 1 Sam 12:3-5; Gen 31:19
- v42 — Ps 31:7; Isa 8:13; Gen 31:29; Gen 31:53; Ex 3:7
- v50 — Jer 42:5; Jer 29:23
- v53 — Gen 31:42; Gen 16:5

Chapter 32

Jacob sent messengers ahead to Esau and learned that Esau was coming to meet him with 400 men; fearful, he divided his company in two and prayed for deliverance. He sent droves of livestock ahead as gifts to appease Esau. That night Jacob wrestled a man until dawn at the ford of the Jabbok; the man touched his hip and dislocated it, but blessed him and renamed him Israel.

- 1

And Jacob went on his way, and the angels of God met him.

Jacob went on his way, and the angels of God met Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** Mahanaim (*ma-ha-NAY-im*) — "Two camps, two hosts" Where the angels of God met Jacob as he returned to Canaan. Later an important city east of the Jordan.

- 2 *And when Jacob saw them, he said, This is God's host: and he called the name of that place Mahanaim.* When Jacob saw them, he said, 'This is God's camp!' So He called the name of that place Mahanaim.

■ NAME NOTE Seir (SEE-er) — "Hairy, rough" Mountainous region south of the Dead Sea, land of Esau/Edom. Named for Esau's hairiness.

- 3 *And Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother unto the land of Seir, the country of Edom.* Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother in the land of Seir, the country of Edom,
- 4 *And he commanded them, saying, Thus shall ye speak unto my lord Esau; Thy servant Jacob saith thus, I have sojourned with Laban, and stayed there until now:* instructing them, 'Thus you shall say to my lord Esau: Thus says your servant Jacob, I have stayed with Laban and stayed until now.
- 5 *And I have oxen, and asses, flocks, and menservants, and womenservants: and I have sent to tell my lord, that I may find grace in thy sight.* I have oxen, donkeys, flocks, male servants, and female servants. I have sent to tell my lord, in order to find favor in your sight.'
- 6 *And the messengers returned to Jacob, saying, We came to thy brother Esau, and also he cometh to meet thee, and four hundred men with him.* The messengers returned to Jacob, saying, 'We came to your brother Esau. He is coming to meet you, and there are four hundred men with him.'
- 7 *Then Jacob was greatly afraid and distressed: and he divided the people that was with him, and the flocks, and herds, and the camels, into two bands;* Then Jacob was greatly afraid and distressed. He divided the people who were with him, and the flocks and herds and camels, into two companies,
- 8 *And said, If Esau come to the one company, and smite it, then the other company which is left shall escape.* thinking, 'If Esau comes to the one company and attacks it, then the other company that is left will escape.'

- 9 *And Jacob said, O God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac, the LORD which saidst unto me, Return unto thy country, and to thy kindred, and I will deal well with thee:* Jacob said, 'O God of my father Abraham and God of my father Isaac, O LORD who said to me, Return to Your country and to Your family, that I may do You good,
- 10 *I am not worthy of the least of all the mercies, and of all the truth, which thou hast shewed unto thy servant; for with my staff I passed over this Jordan; and now I am become two bands.* I am not worthy of the least of all the deeds of mercy and all the faithfulness that You have shown to Your servant, for with only my staff I crossed this Jordan, and now I have become two camps.
- 11 *Deliver me, I pray thee, from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau: for I fear him, lest he will come and smite me, and the mother with the children.* Please deliver me from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau, for I fear him, that he may come and attack me, the mothers with the children.
- 12 *And thou saidst, I will surely do thee good, and make thy seed as the sand of the sea, which cannot be numbered for multitude.* But you said, I will surely do you good, and make your seed as the sand of the sea, which shall be too numerous to count.'
- 13 *And he lodged there that same night; and took of that which came to his hand a present for Esau his brother;* So he stayed there that night, and from what he had with him he took a present for his brother Esau:
- 14 *Two hundred she goats, and twenty he goats, two hundred ewes, and twenty rams,* two hundred female goats and twenty male goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,
- 15 *Thirty milch camels with their colts, forty kine, and ten bulls, twenty she asses, and ten foals.* thirty milk camels and their calves, forty cows and ten bulls, twenty female donkeys and ten male donkeys.
- 16 *And he delivered them into the hand of his servants, every drove by themselves; and said unto his servants, Pass over before me, and put a space betwixt drove and drove.* These he handed over to his servants, every drove by itself, and said to his servants, 'Pass on ahead of me and put a space between drove and drove.'

- 17 *And he commanded the foremost, saying, When Esau my brother meeteth thee, and asketh thee, saying, Whose art thou? and whither goest thou? and whose are these before thee?* He instructed the first, 'When Esau my brother meets you and asks you, To whom do you belong? Where are you going? And whose are these ahead of you?
- 18 *Then thou shalt say, They be thy servant Jacob's; it is a present sent unto my lord Esau: and, behold, also he is behind us.* then you shall say, They belong to your servant Jacob. They are a present sent to my lord Esau. And he is also behind us.'
- 19 *And so commanded he the second, and the third, and all that followed the droves, saying, On this manner shall ye speak unto Esau, when ye find him.* He likewise instructed the second and the third and all who followed the droves, 'You shall say the same thing to Esau when you meet him,
- 20 *And say ye moreover, Behold, thy servant Jacob is behind us. For he said, I will appease him with the present that goeth before me, and afterward I will see his face; peradventure he will accept of me.* you shall say, Moreover, your servant Jacob is behind us.' For he thought, 'I may appease him with the present that goes ahead of me, and afterward I shall see his face. Perhaps he will accept me.'
- 21 *So went the present over before him: and himself lodged that night in the company.* So the present passed on ahead of him. He himself stayed that night in the camp.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jabbok (JAB-ok) — "Emptying, flowing" River flowing east-to-west into the Jordan. Jacob wrestled here the night before meeting Esau.

- 22 *And he rose up that night, and took his two wives, and his two womenservants, and his eleven sons, and passed over the ford Jabbok.* That same night he arose and took his two wives, his two female servants, and his eleven children, and crossed the ford of the Jabbok.
- 23 *And he took them, and sent them over the brook, and sent over that he had.* He took them and sent them across the stream, and everything else that he had.

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| 24 <i>And Jacob was left alone; and there wrestled a man with him until the breaking of the day.</i> | Jacob was left alone. And a man wrestled with him until the breaking of the day. |
| 25 <i>And when he saw that he prevailed not against him, he touched the hollow of his thigh; and the hollow of Jacob's thigh was out of joint, as he wrestled with him.</i> | When the man saw that he did not prevail against Jacob, he touched the socket of his thigh, and the socket of Jacob's thigh was put out of joint as he wrestled with him. |
| 26 <i>And he said, Let me go, for the day breaketh. And he said, I will not let thee go, except thou bless me.</i> | Then he said, 'Let me go, for the day has broken.' But Jacob said, 'I will not let you go unless you bless me.' |
| 27 <i>And he said unto him, What is thy name? And he said, Jacob.</i> | He said to him, 'What is your name?' And he said, 'Jacob.' |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Israel (IZ-ree-el) — "He struggles with God, prince with God" New name given to Jacob after he wrestled the angel at Peniel. Name of the nation descended from his twelve sons.*

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| 28 <i>And he said, Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.</i> | Then he said, 'Your name shall no more be called Jacob, but Israel; for as a prince you have power with God and with men, and have prevailed.' |
| 29 <i>And Jacob asked him, and said, Tell me, I pray thee, thy name. And he said, Wherefore is it that thou dost ask after my name? And he blessed him there.</i> | Then Jacob asked him, 'Please tell me your name.' But he said, 'Why is it that you ask my name?' And there he blessed him. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Peniel (pen-EE-el) — "Face of God" Name Jacob gave to the place where he wrestled God face-to-face and lived. Spelled Penuel in the next verse.*

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| 30 <i>And Jacob called the name of the place Peniel: for I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.</i> | So Jacob called the name of the place Peniel, saying, 'For I have seen God face to face, and yet my life has been delivered.' |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Penuel (pen-YOO-el) — "Face of God" Same place as Peniel — a spelling variant.*

- 31 *And as he passed over Penuel the sun rose upon him, and he halted upon his thigh.* The sun rose upon him as he passed Penuel, limping because of his thigh.
- 32 *Therefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew which shrank, which is upon the hollow of the thigh, unto this day: because he touched the hollow of Jacob's thigh in the sinew that shrank.* Therefore to this day the children of Israel do not eat the sinew of the thigh that is on the hip socket, because he touched the socket of Jacob's thigh on the sinew of the thigh.

Words in this chapter:

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v3** — Gen 25:30; Josh 24:4
v5 — Gen 33:8; Gen 33:15
v9 — Gen 31:42; Ps 34:4-6; Gen 31:3; Gen 31:13; Gen 28:13
v10 — Ps 18:35; Gen 24:27
v12 — Gen 28:13-15
v22 — Deut 3:16; Deut 2:37; 1 Tim 5:8; Josh 12:2
v24 — Hos 12:3-5; Eph 6:12; Luke 13:24; Gen 32:28; Gen 32:30
v25 — 2 Cor 12:7-9
v26 — Hos 12:4; Ps 115:12-13; 2 Cor 12:8-9; Ps 67:1; 1 Chr 4:10
v28 — Rev 2:17; Gen 35:10; Isa 62:2-4; Hos 12:3-5; Gen 17:5
v29 — Judg 13:16-18; Job 11:7; Isa 9:6; Prov 30:4; Hos 6:1
v30 — Ex 24:10-11; Num 12:8; Isa 6:5; Gen 16:13; Deut 5:24

Chapter 33

Esau ran to meet Jacob and they embraced and wept, reconciling after years of separation. Jacob urged Esau to accept his gifts and Esau returned to Seir, while Jacob journeyed to Succoth and then to Shechem in Canaan. There Jacob bought a parcel of land, set up an altar, and called it El-elohe-Israel.

- 1 *And Jacob lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, Esau came, and with him four hundred men. And he divided the children unto Leah, and unto Rachel, and unto the two handmaids.* Jacob lifted up his eyes and looked, and Esau was coming, and four hundred men with him. So he divided the children among Leah and Rachel and the two female servants.
- 2 *And he put the handmaids and their children foremost, and Leah and her children after, and Rachel and Joseph hindermost.* He put the female servants with their children in front, then Leah with her children, and Rachel and Joseph last of all.
- 3 *And he passed over before them, and bowed himself to the ground seven times, until he came near to his brother.* He himself went on before them, bowing himself to the ground seven times, until he came near to his brother.
- 4 *And Esau ran to meet him, and embraced him, and fell on his neck, and kissed him: and they wept.* But Esau ran to meet him and embraced him and fell on his neck and kissed him. They wept.
- 5 *And he lifted up his eyes, and saw the women and the children; and said, Who are those with thee? And he said, The children which God hath graciously given thy servant.* When Esau lifted up his eyes and saw the women and children, he said, 'Who are these with you?' Jacob said, 'The children whom God has graciously given your servant.'
- 6 *Then the handmaidens came near, they and their children, and they bowed themselves.* Then the female servants drew near, they and their children, and bowed down.
- 7 *And Leah also with her children came near, and bowed themselves: and after came Joseph near and Rachel, and they bowed themselves.* Leah likewise and her children drew near and bowed down. And last Joseph and Rachel drew near. They bowed down.
- 8 *And he said, What meanest thou by all this drove which I met? And he said, These are to find grace in the sight of my lord.* Esau said, 'What do you mean by all this company that I met?' Jacob answered, 'To find favor in the sight of my lord.'

- 9 *And Esau said, I have enough, my brother; keep that thou hast unto thyself.* But Esau said, 'I have enough, my brother; keep what you have for yourself.'
- 10 *And Jacob said, Nay, I pray thee, if now I have found grace in thy sight, then receive my present at my hand: for therefore I have seen thy face, as though I had seen the face of God, and thou wast pleased with me.* Jacob said, 'No, please, if I have found favor in your sight, then accept my present from my hand. For I have seen your face, as one sees the face of God, and you have accepted me.'
- 11 *Take, I pray thee, my blessing that is brought to thee; because God hath dealt graciously with me, and because I have enough. And he urged him, and he took it.* Please accept my gift that is brought to you, because God has dealt graciously with me, and because I have enough.' Thus He urged Him. He took it.
- 12 *And he said, Let us take our journey, and let us go, and I will go before thee.* Then Esau said, 'Let us journey on our way. I will go ahead of you.'
- 13 *And he said unto him, My lord knoweth that the children are tender, and the flocks and herds with young are with me: and if men should overdrive them one day, all the flock will die.* But Jacob said to him, 'My lord knows that the children are frail, and that the nursing flocks and herds are a care to me. If they are driven hard for one day, all the flocks will die.'
- 14 *Let my lord, I pray thee, pass over before his servant: and I will lead on softly, according as the cattle that goeth before me and the children be able to endure, until I come unto my lord unto Seir.* Let my lord pass on ahead of his servant. I will lead on slowly, at the pace of the livestock that are ahead of me and at the pace of the children, until I come to my lord in Seir.'
- 15 *And Esau said, Let me now leave with thee some of the folk that are with me. And he said, What needeth it? let me find grace in the sight of my lord.* So Esau said, 'Let me leave with you some of the people who are with me.' But he said, 'What need is there? Let me find favor in the sight of my lord.'
- 16 *So Esau returned that day on his way unto Seir.* So Esau returned that day on his way to Seir.

■ **NAME NOTE Succoth (SUCK-oth)** — "Booths, shelters" Town east of the Jordan where Jacob built booths for his livestock. Later site of Israelite worship.

- 17 *And Jacob journeyed to Succoth, and built him an house, and made booths for his cattle: therefore the name of the place is called Succoth.* But Jacob journeyed to Succoth, and built himself a house, and made booths for his livestock. Therefore the name of the place is called Succoth.

■ **NAME NOTE Shalem (SHAY-lem)** — "Safe, peaceful, complete" Place Jacob arrived "safely" near Shechem. May be a description ("came safely") rather than a proper name. **Shechem (SHEK-em)** — "Shoulder, ridge" Both a city in central Canaan AND the name of the Hivite prince who defiled Dinah. Same name applies to both.

- 18 *And Jacob came to Shalem, a city of Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan, when he came from Padanaram; and pitched his tent before the city.* Jacob came safely to the city of Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan, on his way from Padanaram. He camped before the city.

■ **NAME NOTE Hamor (HAY-mor)** — "Donkey, ass" Hivite ruler of Shechem, father of the prince Shechem. Killed by Simeon and Levi.

- 19 *And he bought a parcel of a field, where he had spread his tent, at the hand of the children of Hamor, Shechem's father, for an hundred pieces of money.* from the sons of Hamor, Shechem's father, he bought for a hundred pieces of money the piece of land on which he had pitched his tent.

■ **NAME NOTE Elelohe-Israel (EL-el-OH-hee-IZ-ree-el)** — "God, the God of Israel" Name Jacob gave to the altar he built at Shechem, declaring the LORD as his God.

- 20 *And he erected there an altar, and called it Elelohe-Israel.* There He erected an altar and called it El-Elohe-Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Joseph (JO-zef) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Leah (LEE-ah) — Jacob's first wife, Laban's older daughter — mother of six of the twelve tribal ancestors and of Dinah; her name may mean 'weary.'

Rachel (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'

Padanaram (*PAD-an-AY-ram*) — The region in Mesopotamia (Syria) where Laban lived — meaning 'the plain of Aram'; Jacob went there to find a wife and worked fourteen years for Rachel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 32:6-7
- v3 — Gen 42:6
- v4 — Gen 45:14-15; Ps 34:4; Luke 15:20; Gen 32:28
- v5 — Ps 127:3; Isa 8:18; Gen 48:9
- v8 — Gen 32:5
- v10 — Job 33:26
- v11 — 1 Sam 25:27; Phil 4:18
- v13 — Isa 40:11
- v15 — Ruth 2:13
- v17 — Ps 60:6; Josh 13:27; Judg 8:5
- v18 — Josh 24:1; Acts 7:16; Judg 9:1
- v19 — John 4:5; Acts 7:16; Josh 24:32

Chapter 34

Shechem the son of Hamor seized Dinah and violated her, then sought to marry her. Jacob's sons answered deceitfully, demanding that all the men of the city be circumcised as a condition; while the men were still in pain, Simeon and Levi killed every male in the city and took Dinah back. Jacob rebuked them for making him odious among the Canaanites.

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| 1 | <i>And Dinah the daughter of Leah, which she bare unto Jacob, went out to see the daughters of the land.</i> | Now Dinah the daughter of Leah, whom she had borne to Jacob, went out to see the women of the land. |
| 2 | <i>And when Shechem the son of Hamor the Hivite, prince of the country, saw her, he took her, and lay with her, and defiled her.</i> | When Shechem the son of Hamor the Hivite, the prince of the land, saw her, he seized her and lay with her and humiliated her. |
| 3 | <i>And his soul clave unto Dinah the daughter of Jacob, and he loved the damsel, and spake kindly unto the damsel.</i> | His soul was drawn to Dinah the daughter of Jacob. He loved the young woman and spoke tenderly to her. |

- 4 *And Shechem spake unto his father Hamor, saying, Get me this damsel to wife.* So Shechem spoke to his father Hamor, saying, 'Get me this girl for my wife.'
- 5 *And Jacob heard that he had defiled Dinah his daughter: now his sons were with his cattle in the field: and Jacob held his peace until they were come.* Now Jacob heard that he had defiled his daughter Dinah. But his sons were with his livestock in the field, so Jacob held his peace until they came.
- 6 *And Hamor the father of Shechem went out unto Jacob to commune with him.* Hamor the father of Shechem went out to Jacob to speak with him.
- 7 *And the sons of Jacob came out of the field when they heard it: and the men were grieved, and they were very wroth, because he had wrought folly in Israel in lying with Jacob's daughter; which thing ought not to be done.* The sons of Jacob came in from the field as soon as they heard of it, and the men were grieved and very angry, because he had done a disgraceful thing in Israel by lying with Jacob's daughter, for such a thing must not be done.
- 8 *And Hamor communed with them, saying, The soul of my son Shechem longeth for your daughter: I pray you give her him to wife.* But Hamor spoke with them, saying, 'The soul of my son Shechem longs for your daughter. Please give her to him to be his wife.'
- 9 *And make ye marriages with us, and give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you.* Make marriages with us: give your daughters to us, and take our daughters for yourselves.
- 10 *And ye shall dwell with us: and the land shall be before you; dwell and trade ye therein, and get you possessions therein.* You shall dwell with us, and the land shall be open to you. Dwell and trade in it, and get property in it.'
- 11 *And Shechem said unto her father and unto her brethren, Let me find grace in your eyes, and what ye shall say unto me I will give.* Shechem also said to her father and to her brothers, 'Let me find favor in your eyes, and whatever you say to me I will give.'

- 12 *Ask me never so much dowry and gift, and I will give according as ye shall say unto me: but give me the damsel to wife.* Ask me for as great a bride-price and gift as you will. I will give whatever you say to me. Only give me the young woman to be my wife.'
- 13 *And the sons of Jacob answered Shechem and Hamor his father deceitfully, and said, because he had defiled Dinah their sister:* The sons of Jacob answered Shechem and his father Hamor deceitfully, because he had defiled their sister Dinah.
- 14 *And they said unto them, We cannot do this thing, to give our sister to one that is uncircumcised; for that were a reproach unto us:* They said to them, 'We cannot do this thing, to give our sister to one who is uncircumcised, for that would be a disgrace to us.
- 15 *But in this will we consent unto you: If ye will be as we be, that every male of you be circumcised;* Only on this condition will we agree with you — that you will become as we are, and every male among you be circumcised.
- 16 *Then will we give our daughters unto you, and we will take your daughters to us, and we will dwell with you, and we will become one people.* Then we will give our daughters to you. We will take your daughters for ourselves. We will dwell with you and become one people.
- 17 *But if ye will not hearken unto us, to be circumcised; then will we take our daughter, and we will be gone.* But if you will not listen to us and be circumcised, then we will take our daughter and go.'
- 18 *And their words pleased Hamor, and Shechem Hamor's son.* Their words pleased Hamor and Hamor's son Shechem.
- 19 *And the young man deferred not to do the thing, because he had delight in Jacob's daughter: and he was more honourable than all the house of his father.* The young man did not delay to do the thing, because he had delight in Jacob's daughter. Now he was the most honored of all his father's house.
- 20 *And Hamor and Shechem his son came unto the gate of their city, and communed with the men of their city, saying,* So Hamor and his son Shechem came to the gate of their city and spoke to the men of their city, saying,

- 21 *These men are peaceable with us; therefore let them dwell in the land, and trade therein; for the land, behold, it is large enough for them; let us take their daughters to us for wives, and let us give them our daughters.* 'These men are at peace with us; let them dwell in the land and trade in it, for the land is large enough for them. Let us take their daughters as wives, and let us give them our daughters.
- 22 *Only herein will the men consent unto us for to dwell with us, to be one people, if every male among us be circumcised, as they are circumcised.* Only on this condition will the men agree to dwell with us to become one people — when every male among us is circumcised as they are circumcised.
- 23 *Shall not their cattle and their substance and every beast of theirs be ours? only let us consent unto them, and they will dwell with us.* Will not their livestock, their property, and all their beasts be ours? Only let us agree with them, and they will dwell with us.'
- 24 *And unto Hamor and unto Shechem his son hearkened all that went out of the gate of his city; and every male was circumcised, all that went out of the gate of his city.* All who went out of the gate of his city listened to Hamor and his son Shechem, and every male was circumcised, all who went out of the gate of his city.
- 25 *And it came to pass on the third day, when they were sore, that two of the sons of Jacob, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brethren, took each man his sword, and came upon the city boldly, and slew all the males.* On the third day, when they were sore, two of the sons of Jacob, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brothers, took their swords and came against the city while it felt secure, and killed all the males.
- 26 *And they slew Hamor and Shechem his son with the edge of the sword, and took Dinah out of Shechem's house, and went out.* They killed Hamor and his son Shechem with the edge of the sword and took Dinah out of Shechem's house and went away.
- 27 *The sons of Jacob came upon the slain, and spoiled the city, because they had defiled their sister.* The sons of Jacob came upon the slain and plundered the city, because they had defiled their sister.

28	<i>They took their sheep, and their oxen, and their asses, and that which was in the city, and that which was in the field,</i>	They took their flocks and their herds and their donkeys, and whatever was in the city and in the field.
29	<i>And all their wealth, and all their little ones, and their wives took they captive, and spoiled even all that was in the house.</i>	All their wealth and all their little ones and all their wives they took captive, and they plundered all that was in the houses.
30	<i>And Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, Ye have troubled me to make me to stink among the inhabitants of the land, among the Canaanites and the Perizzites: and I being few in number, they shall gather themselves together against me, and slay me; and I shall be destroyed, I and my house.</i>	Then Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, 'You have brought trouble on me by making me stink among the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites and the Perizzites. My numbers are few, and if they gather themselves against me and attack me, I shall be destroyed, both I and my household.'
31	<i>And they said, Should he deal with our sister as with an harlot?</i>	But they said, 'Should he treat our sister like a prostitute?'

Words in this chapter:

Perizzites (PEHR-ih-zytes) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Levi (LEE-vy) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Simeon (SIM-ee-on) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 30:21
- v10 — Gen 13:9; Gen 42:34; Gen 47:27; Gen 20:15
- v20 — Ruth 4:1
- v25 — Gen 49:5-7

Chapter 35

God told Jacob to go to Bethel; Jacob put away his household's foreign gods and built an altar there, and God appeared again, confirming his name as Israel and renewing the covenant promises. Rachel died giving birth to Benjamin on the road to Ephrath and was buried there.

Isaac died at 180 in Hebron, and Esau and Jacob buried him.

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| <p>1 <i>And God said unto Jacob, Arise, go up to Bethel, and dwell there: and make there an altar unto God, that appeared unto thee when thou fleddest from the face of Esau thy brother.</i></p> | <p>God said to Jacob, 'Arise, go up to Bethel and dwell there. Make an altar there to the God who appeared to you when you fled from your brother Esau.'</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then Jacob said unto his household, and to all that were with him, Put away the strange gods that are among you, and be clean, and change your garments:</i></p> | <p>So Jacob said to his household and to all who were with him, 'Put away the foreign gods that are among you and purify yourselves and change your garments.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And let us arise, and go up to Bethel; and I will make there an altar unto God, who answered me in the day of my distress, and was with me in the way which I went.</i></p> | <p>Then let us arise and go up to Bethel, so that I may make there an altar to the God Who answered me in the day of my distress and has been with me wherever I have gone.'</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And they gave unto Jacob all the strange gods which were in their hand, and all their earrings which were in their ears; and Jacob hid them under the oak which was by Shechem.</i></p> | <p>So they gave to Jacob all the foreign gods that they had, and the rings that were in their ears. Jacob hid them under the oak that was near Shechem.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And they journeyed: and the terror of God was upon the cities that were round about them, and they did not pursue after the sons of Jacob.</i></p> | <p>As they journeyed, a terror from God fell upon the cities that were around them, so that they did not pursue the sons of Jacob.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>So Jacob came to Luz, which is in the land of Canaan, that is, Bethel, he and all the people that were with him.</i></p> | <p>Jacob came to Luz (that is, Bethel), which is in the land of Canaan, he and all the people who were with him.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** Elbethel (el-BETH-el) — "God of Bethel" Name Jacob gave to the altar at Bethel when he returned there after wrestling the angel.

- 7 *And he built there an altar, and called the place Elbethel: because there God appeared unto him, when he fled from the face of his brother.* There he built an altar and called the place El-bethel, because there God had revealed himself to him when He fled from His brother.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Deborah (DEB-or-uh) — "Bee" Rebekah's nurse. Two Deborahs in Scripture — this one, and later the judge and prophetess in the book of Judges. Allonbachuth (AL-lon-BAH-kooth) — "Oak of weeping" Tree below Bethel where Rebekah's nurse Deborah was buried.*

- 8 *But Deborah Rebekah's nurse died, and she was buried beneath Bethel under an oak: and the name of it was called Allonbachuth.* Deborah, Rebekah's nurse, died. She was buried under an oak below Bethel. So he called its name Allon-bacuth.
- 9 *And God appeared unto Jacob again, when he came out of Padanaram, and blessed him.* God appeared to Jacob again, when he came from Padanaram, and blessed him.
- 10 *And God said unto him, Thy name is Jacob: thy name shall not be called any more Jacob, but Israel shall be thy name: and he called his name Israel.* God said to Him, 'Your name is Jacob; no longer shall your name be called Jacob. But Israel shall be your name.' So he called his name Israel.
- 11 *And God said unto him, I am God Almighty: be fruitful and multiply; a nation and a company of nations shall be of thee, and kings shall come out of thy loins;* God said to Him, 'I am God Almighty. Be fruitful and multiply. A nation and a company of nations shall come from you, and kings shall come from your own body.
- 12 *And the land which I gave Abraham and Isaac, to thee I will give it, and to thy seed after thee will I give the land.* The land that I gave to Abraham and Isaac I will give to you. I will give the land to your seed after you.'
- 13 *And God went up from him in the place where he talked with him.* Then God went up from Him in the place where He had spoken with Him.
- 14 *And Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he talked with him, even a pillar of stone: and he poured a drink offering thereon, and he poured oil thereon.* Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he had spoken with him, a pillar of stone. He poured out a drink offering on it and poured oil on it.

- 15 *And Jacob called the name of the place where God spake with him, Bethel.* So Jacob called the name of the place where God had spoken with him, Bethel.

■ **NAME NOTE** Ephrath (EF-rath) — "Fruitful" Older name for Bethlehem. Site of Rachel's death and burial.

- 16 *And they journeyed from Bethel; and there was but a little way to come to Ephrath: and Rachel travailed, and she had hard labour.* Then they journeyed from Bethel. When they were still some distance from Ephrath, Rachel went into labor. She had hard labor.
- 17 *And it came to pass, when she was in hard labour, that the midwife said unto her, Fear not; thou shalt have this son also.* when her labor was at its hardest, the midwife said to her, 'Do not fear, for you have another son.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Benoni (ben-OH-nye) — "Son of my sorrow" Name Rachel gave her second son with her dying breath. Jacob renamed him Benjamin. Benjamin (BEN-juh-min) — "Son of the right hand, son of the south" Twelfth and youngest son of Jacob, second of Rachel. Jacob renamed him to reverse the ominous meaning of Rachel's chosen name.

- 18 *And it came to pass, as her soul was in departing, (for she died) that she called his name Benoni: but his father called him Benjamin.* as her soul was departing (for she was dying), she called his name Ben-oni; but his father called him Benjamin.

■ **NAME NOTE** Bethlehem (BETH-leh-hem) — "House of bread" Small town south of Jerusalem. Birthplace of David and later of Christ.

- 19 *And Rachel died, and was buried in the way to Ephrath, which is Bethlehem.* So Rachel died. She was buried on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem).
- 20 *And Jacob set a pillar upon her grave: that is the pillar of Rachel's grave unto this day.* Jacob set up a pillar over her tomb. It is the pillar of Rachel's tomb, which is there to this day.

■ **NAME NOTE** Edar (EE-dar) — "Flock" The tower of Eder — a watchtower for flocks, possibly near Bethlehem. Where Israel pitched his tent after Rachel's burial.

- 21 *And Israel journeyed, and spread his tent beyond the tower of Edar.* Israel journeyed on and pitched his tent beyond the tower of Edar.

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| 22 | <i>And it came to pass, when Israel dwelt in that land, that Reuben went and lay with Bilhah his father's concubine: and Israel heard it. Now the sons of Jacob were twelve:</i> | While Israel lived in that land, Reuben went and lay with Bilhah his father's concubine. Israel heard of it. Now the sons of Jacob were twelve. |
| 23 | <i>The sons of Leah; Reuben, Jacob's firstborn, and Simeon, and Levi, and Judah, and Issachar, and Zebulun:</i> | The sons of Leah: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun. |
| 24 | <i>The sons of Rachel; Joseph, and Benjamin:</i> | The sons of Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin. |
| 25 | <i>And the sons of Bilhah, Rachel's handmaid; Dan, and Naphtali:</i> | The sons of Bilhah, Rachel's servant: Dan and Naphtali. |
| 26 | <i>And the sons of Zilpah, Leah's handmaid; Gad, and Asher: these are the sons of Jacob, which were born to him in Padanaram.</i> | The sons of Zilpah, Leah's servant: Gad and Asher. These were the sons of Jacob who were born to him in Padanaram. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Arbah (AR-bah) — "Four, great" A great man among the Anakim; the city of Arba is Kiriath-arba, later called Hebron.

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| 27 | <i>And Jacob came unto Isaac his father unto Mamre, unto the city of Arbah, which is Hebron, where Abraham and Isaac sojourned.</i> | Jacob came to his father Isaac at Mamre, or Kiriath-arba (that is, Hebron), where Abraham and Isaac had stayed. |
| 28 | <i>And the days of Isaac were an hundred and fourscore years.</i> | Now the days of Isaac were 180 years. |
| 29 | <i>And Isaac gave up the ghost, and died, and was gathered unto his people, being old and full of days: and his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.</i> | Isaac breathed his last. He died and was gathered to his people, old and full of days. His sons Esau and Jacob buried him. |

Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (BEN-jah-min) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Deborah (DEB-oh-rah) — A prophetess and judge of Israel — led Israel to victory over Jabin's army through Barak; her name means 'bee.'

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 31:13; Hos 12:4; Ps 91:15
- v2 — Ex 19:10; Ex 19:14; Ezek 18:31; Jas 4:8; 1 Pet 2:1-2
- v3 — Isa 43:2; Gen 32:7; Gen 31:3
- v5 — Ex 23:27; 2 Chr 17:10; Josh 5:1; Ps 14:5
- v9 — Gen 26:2; Gen 35:1; Gen 18:1
- v10 — Gen 17:5; Gen 32:27-28; Gen 17:15
- v11 — Gen 22:17; Gen 9:1; Gen 17:1; 2 Cor 6:18; Ex 6:3
- v12 — Gen 12:7; Gen 28:13
- v19 — Mic 5:2; Gen 48:7
- v27 — Gen 13:18; Gen 23:19
- v28 — Gen 25:7; Gen 50:26
- v29 — Gen 15:15; Gen 49:33; Gen 49:31

Chapter 36

The descendants of Esau (that is, Edom) are listed — his wives, sons, and the chiefs and kings who ruled in the land of Edom before any king reigned in Israel. Esau settled in the hill country of Seir because the land could not support both him and Jacob together.

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| 1 | Now these are the generations of Esau, who is Edom. | These are the generations of Esau (that is, Edom). |
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■ NAME NOTE Aholibamah (*uh-HOL-ih-BAH-mah*) — "Tent of the high place" Hivite wife of Esau, daughter of Anah. Mother of three Edomite chiefs. Anah (*AY-nah*) — "Answering" Horite chief; grandfather and father of Aholibamah. Noted for discovering hot springs in the wilderness. Zibeon (*ZIB-ee-on*) — "Dyed, wild" Hivite ancestor of Aholibamah, Esau's wife.

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| 2 | Esau took his wives of the daughters of Canaan; Adah the daughter of Elon the Hittite, and Aholibamah the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon the Hivite; | Esau took his wives from the daughters of Canaan: Adah the daughter of Elon the Hittite, Aholibamah the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon the Hivite, |
| 3 | And Bashemath Ishmael's daughter, sister of Nebajoth. | Bashemath, Ishmael's daughter, the sister of Nebajoth. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Eliphaz (EL-ih-faz) — "My God is gold" Firstborn son of Esau by Adah. Possibly the Eliphaz who appears in the book of Job as Job's friend from Teman. Reuel (ROO-el) — "Friend of God" Son of Esau by Basemath. Another Reuel later appears as Moses's father-in-law (also called Jethro).

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| 4 | And Adah bare to Esau Eliphaz; and Bashemath bare Reuel; | Adah bore to Esau Eliphaz, and Bashemath bore Reuel, |
| 5 | And Aholibamah bare Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah: these are the sons of Esau, which were born unto him in the land of Canaan. | Aholibamah bore Jeush, Jaalam, and Korah. These are the sons of Esau who were born to him in the land of Canaan. |
| 6 | And Esau took his wives, and his sons, and his daughters, and all the persons of his house, and his cattle, and all his beasts, and all his substance, which he had got in the land of Canaan; and went into the country from the face of his brother Jacob. | Then Esau took his wives, his sons and his daughters and all the members of his household, his livestock, all his beasts, and all his property that he had acquired in the land of Canaan, and went into a land away from his brother Jacob. |
| 7 | For their riches were more than that they might dwell together; and the land wherein they were strangers could not bear them because of their cattle. | For their possessions were too great for them to dwell together, and the land of their sojournings could not support them because of their livestock. |
| 8 | Thus dwelt Esau in mount Seir: Esau is Edom. | So Esau lived in the hill country of Seir. (Esau is Edom.) |
| 9 | And these are the generations of Esau the father of the Edomites in mount Seir: | These are the generations of Esau the father of the Edomites in the hill country of Seir. |
| 10 | These are the names of Esau's sons; Eliphaz the son of Adah the wife of Esau, Reuel the son of Bashemath the wife of Esau. | These are the names of Esau's sons: Eliphaz the son of Adah the wife of Esau, Reuel the son of Bashemath the wife of Esau. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Teman (TEE-man) — "South, right hand" Grandson of Esau through Eliphaz. His name became a region of Edom known for its wise men. Kenaz (KEE-naz) — "Hunter, possession" Grandson of Esau; chief of a clan in Edom. The Kenizzites descended from him.

- 11 *And the sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zepho, and Gatam, and Kenaz.* The sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zepho, Gatam, and Kenaz.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Timna (TIM-nah) — "Restraint, portion" Concubine of Eliphaz; mother of Amalek. A different Timna appears later as sister of Lotan the Horite. Amalek (AM-uh-lek) — "Warlike, one who licks up" Grandson of Esau. Ancestor of the Amalekites — Israel's perennial enemies. God commanded their destruction in Exodus 17.*

- 12 *And Timna was concubine to Eliphaz Esau's son; and she bare to Eliphaz Amalek: these were the sons of Adah Esau's wife.* Timna was a concubine of Eliphaz, Esau's son; she bore Amalek to Eliphaz. These are the sons of Adah, Esau's wife.
- 13 *And these are the sons of Reuel; Nahath, and Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah: these were the sons of Bashemath Esau's wife.* These are the sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. These are the sons of Bashemath, Esau's wife.
- 14 *And these were the sons of Aholibamah, the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon, Esau's wife: and she bare to Esau Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah.* These are the sons of Aholibamah the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon, Esau's wife: she bore to Esau Jeush, Jaalam, and Korah.
- 15 *These were dukes of the sons of Esau: the sons of Eliphaz the firstborn son of Esau; duke Teman, duke Omar, duke Zepho, duke Kenaz,* These are the chiefs of the sons of Esau. The sons of Eliphaz the firstborn of Esau: Chief Teman, Chief Omar, Chief Zepho, Chief Kenaz,
- 16 *Duke Korah, duke Gatam, and duke Amalek: these are the dukes that came of Eliphaz in the land of Edom; these were the sons of Adah.* Chief Korah, Chief Gatam, and Chief Amalek. These are the chiefs descended from Eliphaz in the land of Edom; these are the sons of Adah.
- 17 *And these are the sons of Reuel Esau's son; duke Nahath, duke Zerah, duke Shammah, duke Mizzah: these are the dukes that came of Reuel in the land of Edom; these are the sons of Bashemath Esau's wife.* These are the sons of Reuel, Esau's son: Chief Nahath, Chief Zerah, Chief Shammah, Chief Mizzah. These are the chiefs descended from Reuel in the land of Edom; these are the sons of Bashemath, Esau's wife.

- 18 *And these are the sons of Aholibamah Esau's wife; duke Jeush, duke Jaalam, duke Korah: these were the dukes that came of Aholibamah the daughter of Anah, Esau's wife.* These are the sons of Aholibamah, Esau's wife: Chief Jeush, Chief Jaalam, Chief Korah. These are the chiefs descended from Aholibamah the daughter of Anah, Esau's wife.
- 19 *These are the sons of Esau, who is Edom, and these are their dukes.* These are the sons of Esau (that is, Edom), and these are their chiefs.
- 20 *These are the sons of Seir the Horite, who inhabited the land; Lotan, and Shobal, and Zibeon, and Anah,* These are the sons of Seir the Horite, the inhabitants of the land: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah,
- 21 *And Dishon, and Ezer, and Dishan: these are the dukes of the Horites, the children of Seir in the land of Edom.* Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. These are the chiefs of the Horites, the sons of Seir in the land of Edom.
- 22 *And the children of Lotan were Hori and Hemam; and Lotan's sister was Timna.* The sons of Lotan were Hori and Hemam. Lotan's sister was Timna.
- 23 *And the children of Shobal were these; Alvan, and Manahath, and Ebal, Shepho, and Onam.* These are the sons of Shobal: Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and Onam.
- 24 *And these are the children of Zibeon; both Ajah, and Anah: this was that Anah that found the mules in the wilderness, as he fed the asses of Zibeon his father.* These are the sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah. This is the Anah who found the mules in the wilderness as he pastured the donkeys of Zibeon his father.
- 25 *And the children of Anah were these; Dishon, and Aholibamah the daughter of Anah.* These are the children of Anah: Dishon and Aholibamah the daughter of Anah.
- 26 *And these are the children of Dishon; Hemdan, and Eshban, and Ithran, and Cheran.* These are the sons of Dishon: Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran.
- 27 *The children of Ezer are these; Bilhan, and Zaavan, and Akan.* These are the sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan.
- 28 *The children of Dishan are these; Uz, and Aran.* These are the sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.

- 29 *These are the dukes that came of the Horites; duke Lotan, duke Shobal, duke Zibeon, duke Anah,* These are the chiefs of the Horites: Chief Lotan, Chief Shobal, Chief Zibeon, Chief Anah,
- 30 *Duke Dishon, duke Ezer, duke Dishan: these are the dukes that came of Hori, among their dukes in the land of Seir.* Chief Dishon, Chief Ezer, Chief Dishan. These are the chiefs of the Horites, chief by chief in the land of Seir.
- 31 *And these are the kings that reigned in the land of Edom, before there reigned any king over the children of Israel.* These are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom, before any king reigned over the children of Israel.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Bela (BEE-lah) — "Destruction, swallowing" First king of Edom, son of Beor. Named before any king reigned in Israel.*

- 32 *And Bela the son of Beor reigned in Edom: and the name of his city was Dinhabah.* Bela the son of Beor reigned in Edom, and the name of his city was Dinhabah.
- 33 *And Bela died, and Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his stead.* Bela died, and Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his place.
- 34 *And Jobab died, and Husham of the land of Temani reigned in his stead.* Jobab died, and Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his place.
- 35 *And Husham died, and Hadad the son of Bedad, who smote Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Avith.* Husham died, and Hadad the son of Bedad, who defeated Midian in the country of Moab, reigned in his place, and the name of his city was Avith.
- 36 *And Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his stead.* Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his place.
- 37 *And Samlah died, and Saul of Rehoboth by the river reigned in his stead.* Samlah died, and Saul of Rehoboth by the river reigned in his place.
- 38 *And Saul died, and Baalhanan the son of Achbor reigned in his stead.* Saul died, and Baalhanan the son of Achbor reigned in his place.

39	<i>And Baalhanan the son of Achbor died, and Hadar reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Pau; and his wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab.</i>	Baalhanan the son of Achbor died, and Hadar reigned in his place, and the name of his city was Pau; his wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, daughter of Mezahab.
40	<i>And these are the names of the dukes that came of Esau, according to their families, after their places, by their names; duke Timnah, duke Alvah, duke Jetheth,</i>	These are the names of the chiefs of Esau, according to their clans and their dwelling places, by their names: Chief Timna, Chief Alvah, Chief Jetheth,
41	<i>Duke Aholibamah, duke Elah, duke Pinon,</i>	Chief Aholibamah, Chief Elah, Chief Pinon,
42	<i>Duke Kenaz, duke Teman, duke Mibzar,</i>	Chief Kenaz, Chief Teman, Chief Mibzar,
43	<i>Duke Magdiel, duke Iram: these be the dukes of Edom, according to their habitations in the land of their possession: he is Esau the father of the Edomites.</i>	Chief Magdiel, Chief Iram. These are the chiefs of Edom by their dwelling places in the land of their possession. This is Esau the father of the Edomites.

Words in this chapter:

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 22:17
- v4** — 1 Chr 1:35
- v7** — Gen 13:6; Gen 17:8; Gen 28:4
- v8** — Gen 32:3; Mal 1:3
- v20** — Deut 2:12; Gen 14:6; Deut 2:22
- v29** — Gen 36:20
- v31** — Gen 17:6

Chapter 37

Jacob loved Joseph above all his sons and made him a coat of many colors, which provoked his brothers' hatred; Joseph's dreams of his family bowing down to him deepened their resentment. His brothers conspired to kill him but instead sold him to Midianite merchants for twenty pieces of silver; the merchants took Joseph to Egypt and sold him to Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh. The brothers dipped Joseph's coat in goat's blood and deceived Jacob into believing his son was dead.

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| 1 | <i>And Jacob dwelt in the land wherein his father was a stranger, in the land of Canaan.</i> | Jacob lived in the land of his father's sojournings, in the land of Canaan. |
| 2 | <i>These are the generations of Jacob. Joseph, being seventeen years old, was feeding the flock with his brethren; and the lad was with the sons of Bilhah, and with the sons of Zilpah, his father's wives: and Joseph brought unto his father their evil report.</i> | These are the generations of Jacob. Joseph, being seventeen years old, was pasturing the flock with his brothers. He was a young man with the sons of Bilhah and the sons of Zilpah, his father's wives. And Joseph brought a bad report of them to their father. |
| 3 | <i>Now Israel loved Joseph more than all his children, because he was the son of his old age: and he made him a coat of many colours.</i> | Now Israel loved Joseph more than any of his other sons, because he was the son of his old age. And he made him a coat of many colors. |
| 4 | <i>And when his brethren saw that their father loved him more than all his brethren, they hated him, and could not speak peaceably unto him.</i> | But when his brothers saw that their father loved him more than all his brothers, they hated him and could not speak peaceably to him. |
| 5 | <i>And Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it his brethren: and they hated him yet the more.</i> | Now Joseph had a dream, and when he told it to his brothers they hated him even more. |
| 6 | <i>And he said unto them, Hear, I pray you, this dream which I have dreamed:</i> | He said to them, 'Hear this dream that I have dreamed: |

- 7 *For, behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and, lo, my sheaf arose, and also stood upright; and, behold, your sheaves stood round about, and made obeisance to my sheaf.* we were binding sheaves in the field, and my sheaf arose and stood upright. And your sheaves gathered around and bowed down to my sheaf.'
- 8 *And his brethren said to him, Shalt thou indeed reign over us? or shalt thou indeed have dominion over us? And they hated him yet the more for his dreams, and for his words.* His brothers said to him, 'Are you indeed to reign over us? Are you indeed to rule over us?' So they hated him even more for his dreams and for his words.
- 9 *And he dreamed yet another dream, and told it his brethren, and said, Behold, I have dreamed a dream more; and, behold, the sun and the moon and the eleven stars made obeisance to me.* Then he dreamed another dream and told it to his brothers and said, 'I have dreamed another dream. The sun, the moon, and eleven stars were bowing down to me.'
- 10 *And he told it to his father, and to his brethren: and his father rebuked him, and said unto him, What is this dream that thou hast dreamed? Shall I and thy mother and thy brethren indeed come to bow down ourselves to thee to the earth?* But when he told it to his father and to his brothers, his father rebuked him and said to him, 'What is this dream that you have dreamed? Shall I and your mother and your brothers indeed come to bow ourselves to the ground before you?'
- 11 *And his brethren envied him; but his father observed the saying.* his brothers were jealous of him. But his father kept the saying in mind.
- 12 *And his brethren went to feed their father's flock in Shechem.* Now his brothers went to pasture their father's flock near Shechem.
- 13 *And Israel said unto Joseph, Do not thy brethren feed the flock in Shechem? come, and I will send thee unto them. And he said to him, Here am I.* Israel said to Joseph, 'Are not your brothers pasturing the flock at Shechem? Come, I will send you to them.' And he said to him, 'Here I am.'

- 14 *And he said to him, Go, I pray thee, see whether it be well with thy brethren, and well with the flocks; and bring me word again. So he sent him out of the vale of Hebron, and he came to Shechem.* So he said to him, 'Go now, see if it is well with your brothers and with the flock, and bring me word again.' So he sent him from the Valley of Hebron. He came to Shechem.
- 15 *And a certain man found him, and, behold, he was wandering in the field: and the man asked him, saying, What seekest thou?* A man found him wandering in the fields. The man asked him, 'What are you seeking?'
- 16 *And he said, I seek my brethren: tell me, I pray thee, where they feed their flocks.* 'I am seeking my brothers,' he said. 'Tell me, please, where they are pasturing the flock.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Dothan (DOE-than) — "Two wells, two cisterns" Location north of Shechem where Joseph's brothers cast him into a pit and sold him to the Ishmaelites.

- 17 *And the man said, They are departed hence; for I heard them say, Let us go to Dothan. And Joseph went after his brethren, and found them in Dothan.* The man said, 'They have gone away, for I heard them say, Let us go to Dothan.' So Joseph went after his brothers and found them at Dothan.
- 18 *And when they saw him afar off, even before he came near unto them, they conspired against him to slay him.* They saw him from afar, and before he came near to them they conspired against him to kill him.
- 19 *And they said one to another, Behold, this dreamer cometh.* They said to one another, 'Here comes this dreamer.'
- 20 *Come now therefore, and let us slay him, and cast him into some pit, and we will say, Some evil beast hath devoured him: and we shall see what will become of his dreams.* Come now, let us kill him and throw him into one of the pits. Then we will say that a fierce animal has devoured him. We will see what will become of his dreams.'
- 21 *And Reuben heard it, and he delivered him out of their hands; and said, Let us not kill him.* But when Reuben heard it, he rescued him out of their hands, saying, 'Let us not take his life.'

- 22 *And Reuben said unto them, Shed no blood, but cast him into this pit that is in the wilderness, and lay no hand upon him; that he might rid him out of their hands, to deliver him to his father again.* Reuben said to them, 'Shed no blood; cast him into this pit here in the wilderness, but do not lay a hand on him,' that he might rescue him out of their hands to restore him to his father.
- 23 *And it came to pass, when Joseph was come unto his brethren, that they stript Joseph out of his coat, his coat of many colours that was on him;* So when Joseph came to his brothers, they stripped him of his coat, the coat of many colors that he wore.
- 24 *And they took him, and cast him into a pit: and the pit was empty, there was no water in it.* they took him and cast him into a pit. The pit was empty; there was no water in it.
- 25 *And they sat down to eat bread: and they lifted up their eyes and looked, and, behold, a company of Ishmeelites came from Gilead with their camels bearing spicery and balm and myrrh, going to carry it down to Egypt.* Then they sat down to eat. And looking up they saw a caravan of Ishmeelites coming from Gilead with their camels bearing gum, balm, and myrrh, on their way to carry it down to Egypt.
- 26 *And Judah said unto his brethren, What profit is it if we slay our brother, and conceal his blood?* Then Judah said to his brothers, 'What profit is it if we kill our brother and conceal his blood?
- 27 *Come, and let us sell him to the Ishmeelites, and let not our hand be upon him; for he is our brother and our flesh. And his brethren were content.* Come, let us sell him to the Ishmeelites, and let not our hand be upon him, for he is our brother, our own flesh.' And his brothers listened to him.
- 28 *Then there passed by Midianites merchantmen; and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmeelites for twenty pieces of silver: and they brought Joseph into Egypt.* Then Midianite traders passed by. And they drew Joseph up and lifted him out of the pit, and sold him to the Ishmeelites for twenty pieces of silver. They took Joseph to Egypt.

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| 29 <i>And Reuben returned unto the pit; and, behold, Joseph was not in the pit; and he rent his clothes.</i> | When Reuben returned to the pit and saw that Joseph was not in the pit, he tore his clothes. |
| 30 <i>And he returned unto his brethren, and said, The child is not; and I, whither shall I go?</i> | he He returned to his brothers and said, 'The boy is gone. I, where shall I go?' |
| 31 <i>And they took Joseph's coat, and killed a kid of the goats, and dipped the coat in the blood;</i> | Then they took Joseph's coat and slaughtered a young goat and dipped the coat in the blood. |
| 32 <i>And they sent the coat of many colours, and they brought it to their father; and said, This have we found: know now whether it be thy son's coat or no.</i> | They sent the coat of many colors and brought it to their father and said, 'This we have found; please identify whether it is your son's coat or not.' |
| 33 <i>And he knew it, and said, It is my son's coat; an evil beast hath devoured him; Joseph is without doubt rent in pieces.</i> | He identified it and said, 'It is my son's coat. A fierce animal has devoured him. Joseph is without doubt torn to pieces.' |
| 34 <i>And Jacob rent his clothes, and put sackcloth upon his loins, and mourned for his son many days.</i> | Then Jacob tore his garments and put sackcloth on his loins and mourned for his son many days. |
| 35 <i>And all his sons and all his daughters rose up to comfort him; but he refused to be comforted; and he said, For I will go down into the grave unto my son mourning. Thus his father wept for him.</i> | All his sons and all his daughters rose up to comfort him. But he refused to be comforted and said, 'No, I shall go down to the grave to my son, mourning.' Thus his father wept for him. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Potiphar (POT-ih-fur) — "Given by Ra (Egyptian)" Egyptian officer of Pharaoh, captain of the guard. Joseph's first master in Egypt.

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| 36 <i>And the Midianites sold him into Egypt unto Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh's, and captain of the guard.</i> | Meanwhile the Midianites had sold him in Egypt to Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh, the captain of the guard. |
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Words in this chapter:

Midianites (*MID-ee-an-ytes*) — A nomadic people descended from Abraham's son Midian — Moses fled to Midian; the Midianites oppressed Israel for seven years before Gideon defeated them.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 17:8
- v2 — Gen 35:25-26
- v4 — Gen 27:41; 1 John 4:20; 1 John 3:12
- v5 — Gen 28:12; Gen 42:9; Dan 4:5; John 17:14
- v7 — Gen 44:14; Gen 42:6; Gen 43:26; Gen 42:9
- v9 — Acts 7:9-14
- v11 — Acts 7:9; Luke 2:51; Luke 2:19
- v17 — 2 Kgs 6:13
- v18 — Acts 23:12; Ps 37:12; Ps 37:32; Mark 14:1; 1 Sam 19:1
- v25 — Gen 43:11; Gen 37:28; Jer 8:22
- v28 — Acts 7:9; Ps 105:17; Gen 45:4-5; Gen 25:2
- v33 — Gen 44:28; Gen 37:20

Chapter 38

Judah married a Canaanite woman and had three sons; his firstborn Er died for his wickedness, and Onan was also slain for refusing to raise up seed for his brother. Judah withheld his third son Shelah from Tamar, so she disguised herself, lay with Judah by the roadside, and conceived twins. When Judah learned the truth he declared her more righteous than himself; she bore Pharez and Zarah.

■ **NAME NOTE** Hirah (*HI-rah*) — "Nobility, splendor" Judah's Canaanite friend from the town of Adullam. Adullamite (*uh-DUL-uh-mite*) — "Inhabitant of Adullam (justice of the people)" From Adullam, a Canaanite town in the lowlands. Later David hid in the cave of Adullam from Saul.

1	And it came to pass at that time, that Judah went down from his brethren, and turned in to a certain Adullamite, whose name was Hirah.	At that time Judah went down from his brothers and turned aside to a certain Adullamite, whose name was Hirah.
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■ **NAME NOTE** Shuah (*SHOO-ah*) — "Depression, wealth" Canaanite whose daughter Judah married. (Note: Shua is a separate person, Abraham's son by Keturah.)

2	And Judah saw there a daughter of a certain Canaanite, whose name was Shuah; and he took her, and went in unto her.	There Judah saw the daughter of a certain Canaanite whose name was Shuah. He took her and went in to her,
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■ **NAME NOTE** Er (UR) — "Watchful" Judah's firstborn. Put to death by the LORD for his wickedness.

- 3 *And she conceived, and bare a son; and he called his name Er.* she conceived and bore a son. He called His name Er.

■ **NAME NOTE** Onan (OH-nan) — "Strong, vigorous" Judah's second son. Killed by the LORD for refusing his levirate duty to Tamar. Root of the term "onanism."

- 4 *And she conceived again, and bare a son; and she called his name Onan.* She conceived again and bore a son. She called His name Onan.

■ **NAME NOTE** Shelah (SHEE-lah) — "Request, prayer, quiet" Judah's third son. (Different from Salah in Shem's line.) Judah withheld him from Tamar. Chezib (KEE-zib) — "Deceptive, false" Canaanite town where Shelah was born.

- 5 *And she yet again conceived, and bare a son; and called his name Shelah: and he was at Chezib, when she bare him.* Yet again she bore a son. She called His name Shelah. Judah was in Chezib when she bore Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** Tamar (TAY-mar) — "Palm tree" Judah's daughter-in-law. Widowed twice; conceived Perez and Zerah by Judah. Named in the genealogy of Christ.

- 6 *And Judah took a wife for Er his firstborn, whose name was Tamar.* Judah took a wife for Er His firstborn. Her name was Tamar.
- 7 *And Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in the sight of the LORD; and the LORD slew him.* But Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in the sight of the LORD. The LORD put Him to death.
- 8 *And Judah said unto Onan, Go in unto thy brother's wife, and marry her, and raise up seed to thy brother.* Then Judah said to Onan, 'Go in to Your brother's wife and perform the duty of a brother-in-law to her, and raise up seed for Your brother.'
- 9 *And Onan knew that the seed should not be his; and it came to pass, when he went in unto his brother's wife, that he spilled it on the ground, lest that he should give seed to his brother.* But Onan knew that the seed would not be His. So whenever He went in to His brother's wife He would waste the semen on the ground, so as not to give seed to His brother.

- 10 *And the thing which he did displeased the LORD: wherefore he slew him also.* What He did was displeasing in the sight of the LORD. He put Him to death also.
- 11 *Then said Judah to Tamar his daughter in law, Remain a widow at thy father's house, till Shelah my son be grown: for he said, Lest peradventure he die also, as his brethren did. And Tamar went and dwelt in her father's house.* Then Judah said to Tamar His daughter-in-law, 'Remain a widow in Your father's house, till Shelah my son grows up,' for He feared that He would die, like His brothers. So Tamar went and remained in her father's house.
- **NAME NOTE** Timnath (TIM-nath) — "Portion, allotted share" Town in the Judean hill country where Judah went to shear sheep. Also spelled Timnah.
- 12 *And in process of time the daughter of Shuah Judah's wife died; and Judah was comforted, and went up unto his sheepshearers to Timnath, he and his friend Hirah the Adullamite.* In the course of time the wife of Judah, Shua's daughter, died. When Judah was comforted, He went up to Timnath to His sheepshearers, He and His friend Hirah the Adullamite.
- 13 *And it was told Tamar, saying, Behold thy father in law goeth up to Timnath to shear his sheep.* When Tamar was told, 'Your father-in-law is going up to Timnath to shear his sheep,'
- 14 *And she put her widow's garments off from her, and covered her with a vail, and wrapped herself, and sat in an open place, which is by the way to Timnath; for she saw that Shelah was grown, and she was not given unto him to wife.* she took off her widow's garments and covered herself with a veil, wrapping herself up, and sat in an open place, which is by the way to Timnath. For she saw that Shelah was grown up. She had not been given to Him in marriage.
- 15 *When Judah saw her, he thought her to be an harlot; because she had covered her face.* When Judah saw her, He thought she was a prostitute, for she had covered her face.

- 16 *And he turned unto her by the way, and said, Go to, I pray thee, let me come in unto thee; (for he knew not that she was his daughter in law.) And she said, What wilt thou give me, that thou mayest come in unto me?* He turned to her at the roadside and said, 'Come, let me come in to You,' for He did not know that she was His daughter-in-law. She said, 'What will You give me, that You may come in to me?'
- 17 *And he said, I will send thee a kid from the flock. And she said, Wilt thou give me a pledge, till thou send it?* He answered, 'I will send You a young goat from the flock.' And she said, 'Will You give me a pledge, until You send it?'
- 18 *And he said, What pledge shall I give thee? And she said, Thy signet, and thy bracelets, and thy staff that is in thine hand. And he gave it her, and came in unto her, and she conceived by him.* He said, 'What pledge shall I give You?' She replied, 'Your signet and Your cord and Your staff that is in Your hand.' So He gave them to her and went in to her. She conceived by Him.
- 19 *And she arose, and went away, and laid by her vail from her, and put on the garments of her widowhood.* Then she arose and went away, and taking off her veil she put on the garments of her widowhood.
- 20 *And Judah sent the kid by the hand of his friend the Adullamite, to receive his pledge from the woman's hand: but he found her not.* When Judah sent the young goat by his friend the Adullamite to take back the pledge from the woman's hand, he did not find her.
- 21 *Then he asked the men of that place, saying, Where is the harlot, that was openly by the way side? And they said, There was no harlot in this place.* he asked the men of the place, 'Where is the harlot that was openly by the way side?' And they said, 'No harlot has been here.'
- 22 *And he returned to Judah, and said, I cannot find her; and also the men of the place said, that there was no harlot in this place.* So he returned to Judah and said, 'I have not found her. Also, the men of the place said, No harlot has been here.'

- 23 *And Judah said, Let her take it to her, lest we be shamed: behold, I sent this kid, and thou hast not found her.* Judah said, 'Let her keep the things as her own, or we shall be laughed at. You see, I sent this young goat, and you did not find her.'
- 24 *And it came to pass about three months after, that it was told Judah, saying, Tamar thy daughter in law hath played the harlot; and also, behold, she is with child by whoredom. And Judah said, Bring her forth, and let her be burnt.* About three months later Judah was told, 'Tamar your daughter-in-law has been immoral. Moreover, she is pregnant by immorality.' And Judah said, 'Bring her out, and let her be burned.'
- 25 *When she was brought forth, she sent to her father in law, saying, By the man, whose these are, am I with child: and she said, Discern, I pray thee, whose are these, the signet, and bracelets, and staff.* As she was being brought out, she sent word to her father-in-law, 'By the man to whom these belong, I am with child.' And she said, 'Please identify whose these are, the signet and the cord and the staff.'
- 26 *And Judah acknowledged them, and said, She hath been more righteous than I; because that I gave her not to Shelah my son. And he knew her again no more.* Then Judah identified them and said, 'She is more righteous than I, since I did not give her to my son Shelah.' And he did not know her again.
- 27 *And it came to pass in the time of her travail, that, behold, twins were in her womb.* When the time of her labor came, there were twins in her womb.
- 28 *And it came to pass, when she travailed, that the one put out his hand: and the midwife took and bound upon his hand a scarlet thread, saying, This came out first.* When she was in labor, one put out a hand, and the midwife took and tied a scarlet thread on his hand, saying, 'This one came out first.'

■ NAME NOTE Pharez (FAIR-ez) — "Breach, breaking forth" Twin son of Judah by Tamar. Ancestor of David and of Christ. Also spelled Perez.

- 29

And it came to pass, as he drew back his hand, that, behold, his brother came out: and she said, How hast thou broken forth? this breach be upon thee: therefore his name was called Pharez.
- But as He drew back His hand, His brother came out. And she said, 'What a breach You have made for Yourself!' Therefore His name was called Pharez.

■ **NAME NOTE** Zarah (ZAI-rah) — "Rising, dawn" Twin son of Judah by Tamar, brother of Perez. Also spelled Zerah.

- 30

And afterward came out his brother, that had the scarlet thread upon his hand: and his name was called Zarah.
- Afterward His brother came out with the scarlet thread on His hand. His name was called Zarah.

Words in this chapter:

- whoredom** — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.
- Pharez** (FAIR-ez) — Twin son of Judah and Tamar — ancestor of King David and of Jesus; his name means 'breach' because he broke out first from the womb unexpectedly.
- Zarah** (ZAY-rah) — Twin brother of Pharez, son of Judah and Tamar — the midwife tied a scarlet thread on his hand first, but Pharez was born ahead of him; his name means 'rising' or 'brightness.'

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 Chr 2:3
- v3** — Num 26:19; Gen 46:12
- v7** — 1 Chr 2:3; Gen 46:12; Num 26:19
- v8** — Deut 25:5-10; Matt 22:23-27
- v11** — Lev 22:13
- v24** — Lev 21:9
- v26** — 1 Sam 24:17
- v29** — 1 Chr 2:4; Num 26:20; Matt 1:3; Gen 46:12
- v30** — 1 Chr 9:6

Chapter 39

Joseph prospered in Potiphar's house because the LORD was with him, and Potiphar put him in charge of everything he owned. Potiphar's wife repeatedly tried to seduce Joseph; when he refused and fled, she falsely accused him. Potiphar cast Joseph into prison, but the LORD was with him there, and the keeper of the prison put everything in Joseph's charge.

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| 1 | <i>And Joseph was brought down to Egypt; and Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh, captain of the guard, an Egyptian, bought him of the hands of the Ishmeelites, which had brought him down thither.</i> | Now Joseph had been brought down to Egypt, and Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh, the captain of the guard, an Egyptian, had bought him from the Ishmeelites who had brought him down there. |
| 2 | <i>And the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian.</i> | The LORD was with Joseph. He became a successful man. He was in the house of His Egyptian master. |
| 3 | <i>And his master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did to prosper in his hand.</i> | His master saw that the LORD was with Him and that the LORD caused all that He did to succeed in His hand. |
| 4 | <i>And Joseph found grace in his sight, and he served him: and he made him overseer over his house, and all that he had he put into his hand.</i> | So Joseph found favor in his sight and attended him. He made him overseer of his house and put him in charge of all that he had. |
| 5 | <i>And it came to pass from the time that he had made him overseer in his house, and over all that he had, that the LORD blessed the Egyptian's house for Joseph's sake; and the blessing of the LORD was upon all that he had in the house, and in the field.</i> | From the time that He made Him overseer in His house and over all that He had, the LORD blessed the Egyptian's house for Joseph's sake, and the blessing of the LORD was on all that He had, in house and field. |
| 6 | <i>And he left all that he had in Joseph's hand; and he knew not ought he had, save the bread which he did eat. And Joseph was a goodly person, and well favoured.</i> | So he left all that he had in Joseph's charge, and because of him he had no concern about anything but the food he ate. Now Joseph was handsome in form and appearance. |
| 7 | <i>And it came to pass after these things, that his master's wife cast her eyes upon Joseph; and she said, Lie with me.</i> | After a time his master's wife cast her eyes on Joseph and said, 'Lie with me.' |

- 8 *But he refused, and said unto his master's wife, Behold, my master wotteth not what is with me in the house, and he hath committed all that he hath to my hand;* But he refused and said to his master's wife, 'because of me my master has no concern about anything in the house. He has put everything that he has in my charge.
- 9 *There is none greater in this house than I; neither hath he kept back any thing from me but thee, because thou art his wife: how then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?* He is not greater in this house than I am, nor has he kept back anything from me except you, because you are his wife. How then can I do this great wickedness and sin against God?
- 10 *And it came to pass, as she spake to Joseph day by day, that he hearkened not unto her, to lie by her, or to be with her.* As she spoke to Joseph day after day, he would not listen to her, to lie beside her or to be with her.
- 11 *And it came to pass about this time, that Joseph went into the house to do his business; and there was none of the men of the house there within.* But one day, when he went into the house to do his work and none of the men of the house was there in the house,
- 12 *And she caught him by his garment, saying, Lie with me: and he left his garment in her hand, and fled, and got him out.* she caught him by his garment, saying, 'Lie with me.' But he left his garment in her hand and fled and got out of the house.
- 13 *And it came to pass, when she saw that he had left his garment in her hand, and was fled forth,* As soon as she saw that he had left his garment in her hand and had fled out of the house,
- 14 *That she called unto the men of her house, and spake unto them, saying, See, he hath brought in an Hebrew unto us to mock us; he came in unto me to lie with me, and I cried with a loud voice:* she called to the men of her house and said to them, 'See, he has brought among us a Hebrew to laugh at us. He came in to me to lie with me. I cried out with a loud voice.

- 15 *And it came to pass, when he heard that I lifted up my voice and cried, that he left his garment with me, and fled, and got him out.* when he heard that I lifted up my voice and cried out, he left his garment beside me and fled and got out of the house.'
- 16 *And she laid up his garment by her, until his lord came home.* Then she laid up his garment by her until his master came home,
- 17 *And she spake unto him according to these words, saying, The Hebrew servant, which thou hast brought unto us, came in unto me to mock me:* She told him the same story, saying, 'The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought among us, came in to me to laugh at me.
- 18 *And it came to pass, as I lifted up my voice and cried, that he left his garment with me, and fled out.* But as soon as I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment beside me and fled out of the house.'
- 19 *And it came to pass, when his master heard the words of his wife, which she spake unto him, saying, After this manner did thy servant to me; that his wrath was kindled.* As soon as his master heard the words that his wife spoke to him, 'This is the way your servant treated me,' his anger was kindled.
- 20 *And Joseph's master took him, and put him into the prison, a place where the king's prisoners were bound: and he was there in the prison.* Joseph's master took him and put him into the prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined. He was there in prison.
- 21 *But the LORD was with Joseph, and shewed him mercy, and gave him favour in the sight of the keeper of the prison.* But the LORD was with Joseph and showed him mercy and gave him favor in the sight of the keeper of the prison.
- 22 *And the keeper of the prison committed to Joseph's hand all the prisoners that were in the prison; and whatsoever they did there, he was the doer of it.* The keeper of the prison put Joseph in charge of all the prisoners who were in the prison. Whatever was done there, he was the one who did it.

- 23 *The keeper of the prison looked not to any thing that was under his hand; because the LORD was with him, and that which he did, the LORD made it to prosper.* The keeper of the prison paid no attention to anything that was in Joseph's charge, because the LORD was with Him. And whatever He did, the LORD made it succeed.

Words in this chapter:

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 105:17; Gen 37:28; Gen 37:25; Gen 37:36
 v2 — 1 Sam 18:14; Ps 91:15; Jer 15:20; Gen 26:28; Acts 7:9-10
 v3 — Ps 1:3; Matt 5:16; Gen 30:27; 1 Sam 18:14; 2 Chr 26:5
 v4 — Gen 39:21-22
 v5 — Gen 30:27; 2 Sam 6:11-12; Acts 27:24; Gen 12:2; Ps 72:17
 v6 — Luke 19:17; Prov 31:11; Gen 29:17; 1 Sam 16:12
 v7 — 2 Sam 13:11; 2 Pet 2:14; Ezek 16:34
 v9 — 2 Sam 12:13; Gen 42:18; Gen 20:6
 v10 — 1 Pet 2:11; 1 Thess 5:22; 2 Tim 2:22; 1 Cor 15:33; 1 Cor 6:18
 v12 — 2 Tim 2:22; Prov 7:13-27; 1 Pet 2:11; Prov 6:5; Prov 5:8
 v21 — Isa 41:10; Ex 3:21; Acts 7:9-10; 1 Pet 3:17; Isa 43:2
 v23 — Isa 43:2; Ps 1:3; Gen 39:2-3; Dan 6:22

Chapter 40

Pharaoh's chief cupbearer and chief baker were imprisoned with Joseph, and each had a dream the same night. Joseph interpreted the cupbearer's dream as restoration to his post in three days, and the baker's as execution in three days — both came to pass exactly as Joseph said. The cupbearer forgot Joseph and did not mention him to Pharaoh.

- 1 *And it came to pass after these things, that the butler of the king of Egypt and his baker had offended their lord the king of Egypt.* Some time after this, the cupbearer of the king of Egypt and his baker committed an offense against their lord the king of Egypt.
- 2 *And Pharaoh was wroth against two of his officers, against the chief of the butlers, and against the chief of the bakers.* Pharaoh was angry with his two officers, the chief cupbearer and the chief baker,

- 3 *And he put them in ward in the house of the captain of the guard, into the prison, the place where Joseph was bound.* he put them in custody in the house of the captain of the guard, in the prison where Joseph was confined.
- 4 *And the captain of the guard charged Joseph with them, and he served them: and they continued a season in ward.* The captain of the guard appointed Joseph to be with them. He attended them. They continued for some time in custody.
- 5 *And they dreamed a dream both of them, each man his dream in one night, each man according to the interpretation of his dream, the butler and the baker of the king of Egypt, which were bound in the prison.* One night they both dreamed, the cupbearer and the baker of the king of Egypt, who were confined in the prison—each his own dream, and each dream with its own interpretation.
- 6 *And Joseph came in unto them in the morning, and looked upon them, and, behold, they were sad.* When Joseph came to them in the morning, he saw that they were troubled.
- 7 *And he asked Pharaoh's officers that were with him in the ward of his lord's house, saying, Wherefore look ye so sadly to day?* So he asked Pharaoh's officers who were with him in custody in his master's house, 'Why are your faces downcast today?'
- 8 *And they said unto him, We have dreamed a dream, and there is no interpreter of it. And Joseph said unto them, Do not interpretations belong to God? tell me them, I pray you.* They said to him, 'We have had dreams, and there is no one to interpret them.' And Joseph said to them, 'Do not interpretations belong to God? Please tell them to me.'
- 9 *And the chief butler told his dream to Joseph, and said to him, In my dream, behold, a vine was before me;* So the chief cupbearer told his dream to Joseph and said to him, 'In my dream there was a vine before me,
- 10 *And in the vine were three branches: and it was as though it budded, and her blossoms shot forth; and the clusters thereof brought forth ripe grapes:* on the vine there were three branches. As soon as it budded, its blossoms shot forth, and the clusters ripened into grapes.

- 11 *And Pharaoh's cup was in my hand: and I took the grapes, and pressed them into Pharaoh's cup, and I gave the cup into Pharaoh's hand.* Pharaoh's cup was in my hand. I took the grapes and pressed them into Pharaoh's cup and placed the cup in Pharaoh's hand.'
- 12 *And Joseph said unto him, This is the interpretation of it: The three branches are three days:* Then Joseph said to him, 'This is its interpretation: the three branches are three days.
- 13 *Yet within three days shall Pharaoh lift up thine head, and restore thee unto thy place: and thou shalt deliver Pharaoh's cup into his hand, after the former manner when thou wast his butler.* In three days Pharaoh will lift up your head and restore you to your office, and you shall place Pharaoh's cup in his hand as formerly, when you were his cupbearer.
- 14 *But think on me when it shall be well with thee, and shew kindness, I pray thee, unto me, and make mention of me unto Pharaoh, and bring me out of this house:* Only remember me, when it is well with you, and please do me the kindness to mention me to Pharaoh, and so get me out of this house.
- 15 *For indeed I was stolen away out of the land of the Hebrews: and here also have I done nothing that they should put me into the dungeon.* For I was indeed stolen out of the land of the Hebrews, and here also I have done nothing that they should put me into the pit.'
- 16 *When the chief baker saw that the interpretation was good, he said unto Joseph, I also was in my dream, and, behold, I had three white baskets on my head:* When the chief baker saw that the interpretation was favorable, he said to Joseph, 'I also had a dream: there were three cake baskets on my head,
- 17 *And in the uppermost basket there was of all manner of bakemeats for Pharaoh; and the birds did eat them out of the basket upon my head.* in the uppermost basket there were all sorts of baked food for Pharaoh, but the birds were eating it out of the basket on my head.'
- 18 *And Joseph answered and said, This is the interpretation thereof: The three baskets are three days:* Joseph answered and said, 'This is its interpretation: the three baskets are three days.

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| <p>19 <i>Yet within three days shall Pharaoh lift up thy head from off thee, and shall hang thee on a tree; and the birds shall eat thy flesh from off thee.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And it came to pass the third day, which was Pharaoh's birthday, that he made a feast unto all his servants: and he lifted up the head of the chief butler and of the chief baker among his servants.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And he restored the chief butler unto his butlership again; and he gave the cup into Pharaoh's hand:</i></p> <p>22 <i>But he hanged the chief baker: as Joseph had interpreted to them.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Yet did not the chief butler remember Joseph, but forgot him.</i></p> | <p>In three days Pharaoh will lift up your head—from you!—and hang you on a tree. And the birds will eat the flesh from you.'</p> <p>On the third day, which was Pharaoh's birthday, he made a feast for all his servants and lifted up the head of the chief cupbearer and the head of the chief baker among his servants.</p> <p>He restored the chief cupbearer to his position. He placed the cup in Pharaoh's hand.</p> <p>But he hanged the chief baker, as Joseph had interpreted to them.</p> <p>Yet the chief cupbearer did not remember Joseph, but forgot him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Prov 16:14
- v3 — Gen 39:20
- v7 — Neh 2:2
- v8 — Dan 2:47; Gen 41:15-16; Dan 2:28
- v11 — Neh 1:11-2:1
- v14 — Josh 2:12
- v20 — Gen 40:13; Gen 40:19; Matt 14:6
- v21 — Gen 40:13
- v22 — Gen 40:19

Chapter 41

Two years later Pharaoh dreamed of seven fat cows devoured by seven thin cows and seven plump ears of grain swallowed by seven thin ears; none of his wise men could interpret the

dreams. The cupbearer finally remembered Joseph, who was brought from prison and told Pharaoh the dreams meant seven years of plenty followed by seven years of famine. Pharaoh set Joseph over all Egypt to store grain during the years of abundance.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass at the end of two full years, that Pharaoh dreamed: and, behold, he stood by the river.</i> | After two whole years, Pharaoh dreamed that he was standing by the Nile, |
| 2 | <i>And, behold, there came up out of the river seven well favoured kine and fatfleshed; and they fed in a meadow.</i> | There came up out of the Nile seven cows, attractive and plump. They fed in the reed grass. |
| 3 | <i>And, behold, seven other kine came up after them out of the river, ill favoured and leanfleshed; and stood by the other kine upon the brink of the river.</i> | Seven other cows, ugly and thin, came up out of the Nile after them and stood by the other cows on the bank of the Nile. |
| 4 | <i>And the ill favoured and leanfleshed kine did eat up the seven well favoured and fat kine. So Pharaoh awoke.</i> | The ugly, thin cows ate up the seven attractive, plump cows. And Pharaoh awoke. |
| 5 | <i>And he slept and dreamed the second time: and, behold, seven ears of corn came up upon one stalk, rank and good.</i> | He fell asleep and dreamed a second time. And seven ears of grain, plump and good, were growing on one stalk. |
| 6 | <i>And, behold, seven thin ears and blasted with the east wind sprung up after them.</i> | After them sprouted seven ears, thin and blighted by the east wind. |
| 7 | <i>And the seven thin ears devoured the seven rank and full ears. And Pharaoh awoke, and, behold, it was a dream.</i> | The thin ears swallowed up the seven plump, full ears. And Pharaoh awoke. It was a dream. |
| 8 | <i>And it came to pass in the morning that his spirit was troubled; and he sent and called for all the magicians of Egypt, and all the wise men thereof: and Pharaoh told them his dream; but there was none that could interpret them unto Pharaoh.</i> | So in the morning his spirit was troubled. He sent and called for all the magicians of Egypt and all its wise men. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but there was none who could interpret them to Pharaoh. |

- 9 *Then spake the chief butler unto Pharaoh, saying, I do remember my faults this day:* Then the chief cupbearer said to Pharaoh, 'I remember my offenses today.
- 10 *Pharaoh was wroth with his servants, and put me in ward in the captain of the guard's house, both me and the chief baker:* When Pharaoh was angry with his servants and put me and the chief baker in custody in the house of the captain of the guard,
- 11 *And we dreamed a dream in one night, I and he; we dreamed each man according to the interpretation of his dream.* we dreamed on the same night, he and I, each having a dream with its own interpretation.
- 12 *And there was there with us a young man, an Hebrew, servant to the captain of the guard; and we told him, and he interpreted to us our dreams; to each man according to his dream he did interpret.* A young Hebrew was there with us, a servant of the captain of the guard. When we told him, he interpreted our dreams to us, giving to each man an interpretation.
- 13 *And it came to pass, as he interpreted to us, so it was; me he restored unto mine office, and him he hanged.* as he interpreted to us, so it came to pass; I was restored to my office, and the baker was hanged.'
- 14 *Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon: and he shaved himself, and changed his raiment, and came in unto Pharaoh.* Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph. They quickly brought him out of the pit. And when he had shaved himself and changed his clothes, he came in before Pharaoh.
- 15 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, I have dreamed a dream, and there is none that can interpret it: and I have heard say of thee, that thou canst understand a dream to interpret it.* Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'I have had a dream, and there is no one to interpret it. I have heard it said of you that when you hear a dream you can interpret it.'
- 16 *And Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, It is not in me: God shall give Pharaoh an answer of peace.* Joseph answered Pharaoh, 'It is not in me; God will give Pharaoh a favorable answer.'

- 17 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, In my dream, behold, I stood upon the bank of the river:* Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, ' in my dream I was standing on the banks of the Nile.
- 18 *And, behold, there came up out of the river seven kine, fatfleshed and well favoured; and they fed in a meadow:* Seven cows, plump and attractive, came up out of the Nile and fed in the reed grass.
- 19 *And, behold, seven other kine came up after them, poor and very ill favoured and leanfleshed, such as I never saw in all the land of Egypt for badness:* Seven other cows came up after them, poor and very ugly and thin, such as I had never seen in all the land of Egypt.
- 20 *And the lean and the ill favoured kine did eat up the first seven fat kine:* The thin, ugly cows ate up the first seven plump cows,
- 21 *And when they had eaten them up, it could not be known that they had eaten them; but they were still ill favoured, as at the beginning. So I awoke.* but when they had eaten them no one would have known that they had eaten them, for they were still as ugly as at the beginning. Then I awoke.
- 22 *And I saw in my dream, and, behold, seven ears came up in one stalk, full and good:* I also saw in my dream seven ears growing on one stalk, full and good.
- 23 *And, behold, seven ears, withered, thin, and blasted with the east wind, sprung up after them:* Seven ears, withered, thin, and blighted by the east wind, sprouted after them,
- 24 *And the thin ears devoured the seven good ears: and I told this unto the magicians; but there was none that could declare it to me.* The thin ears swallowed up the seven good ears. And I told it to the magicians, but there was no one who could explain it to me.'
- 25 *And Joseph said unto Pharaoh, The dream of Pharaoh is one: God hath shewed Pharaoh what he is about to do.* Then Joseph said to Pharaoh, 'The dreams of Pharaoh are one; God has revealed to Pharaoh what he is about to do.
- 26 *The seven good kine are seven years; and the seven good ears are seven years: the dream is one.* The seven good cows are seven years, and the seven good ears are seven years; the dreams are one.

- 27 *And the seven thin and ill favoured kine that came up after them are seven years; and the seven empty ears blasted with the east wind shall be seven years of famine.* The seven lean and ugly cows that came up after them are seven years, and the seven empty ears blighted by the east wind are also seven years of famine.
- 28 *This is the thing which I have spoken unto Pharaoh: What God is about to do he sheweth unto Pharaoh.* It is as I told Pharaoh: God has shown to Pharaoh what he is about to do.
- 29 *Behold, there come seven years of great plenty throughout all the land of Egypt:* There will come seven years of great plenty throughout all the land of Egypt,
- 30 *And there shall arise after them seven years of famine; and all the plenty shall be forgotten in the land of Egypt; and the famine shall consume the land;* but after them there will arise seven years of famine. All the plenty will be forgotten in the land of Egypt. The famine will consume the land,
- 31 *And the plenty shall not be known in the land by reason of that famine following; for it shall be very grievous.* the plenty will be unknown in the land because of the famine that follows, for it will be very severe.
- 32 *And for that the dream was doubled unto Pharaoh twice; it is because the thing is established by God, and God will shortly bring it to pass.* the doubling of Pharaoh's dream means that the thing is fixed by God. God will shortly bring it about.
- 33 *Now therefore let Pharaoh look out a man discreet and wise, and set him over the land of Egypt.* Now therefore let Pharaoh select a discerning and wise man, and set him over the land of Egypt.
- 34 *Let Pharaoh do this, and let him appoint officers over the land, and take up the fifth part of the land of Egypt in the seven plenteous years.* Let Pharaoh proceed to appoint overseers over the land and take one-fifth of the produce of the land of Egypt during the seven plentiful years.

- 35 *And let them gather all the food of those good years that come, and lay up corn under the hand of Pharaoh, and let them keep food in the cities.* let them gather all the food of these good years that are coming and store up grain under the authority of Pharaoh for food in the cities, and let them keep it.
- 36 *And that food shall be for store to the land against the seven years of famine, which shall be in the land of Egypt; that the land perish not through the famine.* That food shall be a reserve for the land against the seven years of famine that are to occur in the land of Egypt, so that the land may not perish through the famine.'
- 37 *And the thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants.* This proposal pleased Pharaoh and all his servants.
- 38 *And Pharaoh said unto his servants, Can we find such a one as this is, a man in whom the Spirit of God is?* Pharaoh said to his servants, 'Can we find a man like this, in whom is the Spirit of God?'
- 39 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Forasmuch as God hath shewed thee all this, there is none so discreet and wise as thou art:* Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'Since God has shown you all this, there is none so discerning and wise as you are.
- 40 *Thou shalt be over my house, and according unto thy word shall all my people be ruled: only in the throne will I be greater than thou.* You shall be over my house. All my people shall order themselves as you command. Only as regards the throne will I be greater than you.'
- 41 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.* Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'See, I have set you over all the land of Egypt.'
- 42 *And Pharaoh took off his ring from his hand, and put it upon Joseph's hand, and arrayed him in vestures of fine linen, and put a gold chain about his neck;* Then Pharaoh took his signet ring from his hand and put it on Joseph's hand, and clothed him in garments of fine linen and put a gold chain about his neck.

- 43 *And he made him to ride in the second chariot which he had; and they cried before him, Bow the knee: and he made him ruler over all the land of Egypt.* he made him ride in his second chariot. And they called out before him, 'Bow the knee!' Thus he set him over all the land of Egypt.
- 44 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, I am Pharaoh, and without thee shall no man lift up his hand or foot in all the land of Egypt.* Moreover, Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'I am Pharaoh, and without your consent no one shall lift up hand or foot in all the land of Egypt.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Zaphnathpaaneah (ZAF-nath-pah-uh-NAY-uh) — "Revealer of secrets, or sustainer of life" Egyptian name Pharaoh gave to Joseph when he made him ruler over Egypt. Asenath (AS-eh-nath) — "Belonging to the goddess Neith" Egyptian wife of Joseph, daughter of the priest of On. Mother of Manasseh and Ephraim. Potipherah (po-TIF-er-ah) — "He whom Ra gave (Egyptian)" Priest of On, father-in-law of Joseph. Related in form to Potiphar but a different man. On (ON) — "Strength, vigor" Egyptian city better known by its Greek name Heliopolis — "city of the sun." Center of sun-worship.

- 45 *And Pharaoh called Joseph's name Zaphnathpaaneah; and he gave him to wife Asenath the daughter of Potipherah priest of On. And Joseph went out over all the land of Egypt.* Pharaoh called Joseph's name Zaphnathpaaneah. And he gave him in marriage Asenath, the daughter of Potipherah priest of On. So Joseph went out over the land of Egypt.
- 46 *And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.* Joseph was thirty years old when he entered the service of Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh and went through all the land of Egypt.
- 47 *And in the seven plenteous years the earth brought forth by handfuls.* During the seven plentiful years the earth produced abundantly,
- 48 *And he gathered up all the food of the seven years, which were in the land of Egypt, and laid up the food in the cities: the food of the field, which was round about every city, laid he up in the same.* He gathered up all the food of these seven years, which occurred in the land of Egypt, and put the food in the cities. He put in every city the food from the fields around it.

- 49 *And Joseph gathered corn as the sand of the sea, very much, until he left numbering; for it was without number.* Joseph stored up grain in great abundance, like the sand of the sea, until he ceased to measure it, for it could not be measured.
- 50 *And unto Joseph were born two sons before the years of famine came, which Asenath the daughter of Potipherah priest of On bare unto him.* Before the year of famine came, two sons were born to Joseph. Asenath, the daughter of Potipherah priest of On, bore them to him.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Manasseh (muh-NAS-uh) — "Making to forget" Joseph's firstborn. Named for how God made Joseph forget his hardship. Later a half-tribe of Israel.*

- 51 *And Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasseh: For God, said he, hath made me forget all my toil, and all my father's house.* Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasseh, 'For,' he said, 'God has made me forget all my hardship and all my father's house.'

■ **NAME NOTE** *Ephraim (EE-fray-im) — "Double fruitfulness" Joseph's second son. Received the greater blessing from Jacob though he was younger. Later a dominant tribe in northern Israel.*

- 52 *And the name of the second called he Ephraim: For God hath caused me to be fruitful in the land of my affliction.* The name of the second he called Ephraim, 'For God has made me fruitful in the land of my affliction.'
- 53 *And the seven years of plenteousness, that was in the land of Egypt, were ended.* The seven years of plenty that occurred in the land of Egypt came to an end,
- 54 *And the seven years of dearth began to come, according as Joseph had said: and the dearth was in all lands; but in all the land of Egypt there was bread.* The seven years of famine began to come, as Joseph had said. There was famine in all lands, but in all the land of Egypt there was bread.
- 55 *And when all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread: and Pharaoh said unto all the Egyptians, Go unto Joseph; what he saith to you, do.* When all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread. Pharaoh said to all the Egyptians, 'Go to Joseph. What he says to you, do.'

- 56

And the famine was over all the face of the earth: And Joseph opened all the storehouses, and sold unto the Egyptians; and the famine waxed sore in the land of Egypt.
- 57

And all countries came into Egypt to Joseph for to buy corn; because that the famine was so sore in all lands.
- So when the famine had spread over all the land, Joseph opened all the storehouses and sold to the Egyptians, for the famine was severe in the land of Egypt.
- Moreover, all the earth came to Egypt to Joseph to buy grain, because the famine was severe over all the earth.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v8** — Dan 4:7; Ex 7:22
- v14** — Dan 2:25; Ps 113:7-8; Ps 105:19-22
- v16** — 2 Cor 3:5; Gen 40:8; Dan 2:47; Num 12:6; Acts 3:12
- v32** — Num 23:19; Isa 46:10-11
- v33** — Gen 41:39; Acts 6:3
- v38** — Job 32:8; Dan 5:14; Num 27:18; Dan 5:11; Dan 4:18
- v39** — Gen 41:28; Gen 41:33
- v40** — Prov 22:29; Acts 7:10; Ps 105:21-22
- v41** — Matt 28:18; Phil 2:9-11; Gen 42:6; Dan 6:3
- v42** — Dan 5:7; Dan 5:29; Esth 3:10; Dan 5:16; Esth 8:2
- v50** — Gen 46:20; Gen 48:5
- v52** — Gen 49:22; Gen 50:23; Gen 17:6

Chapter 42

Jacob sent ten of his sons to buy grain in Egypt, but kept Benjamin home; Joseph recognized his brothers but concealed his identity, accused them of being spies, and imprisoned them for three days. He kept Simeon as a hostage and sent the others back to Canaan with grain and their money secretly returned in their sacks, demanding they bring Benjamin on their next trip.

- 1

Now when Jacob saw that there was corn in Egypt, Jacob said unto his sons, Why do ye look one upon another?
- When Jacob learned that there was grain for sale in Egypt, he said to his sons, 'Why do you look at one another?'

- 2 *And he said, Behold, I have heard that there is corn in Egypt: get you down thither, and buy for us from thence; that we may live, and not die.* He said, 'I have heard that there is grain for sale in Egypt. Go down and buy grain for us there, that we may live and not die.'
- 3 *And Joseph's ten brethren went down to buy corn in Egypt.* So ten of Joseph's brothers went down to buy grain in Egypt.
- 4 *But Benjamin, Joseph's brother, Jacob sent not with his brethren; for he said, Lest peradventure mischief befall him.* But Jacob did not send Benjamin, Joseph's brother, with his brothers, for he feared that harm might happen to him.
- 5 *And the sons of Israel came to buy corn among those that came: for the famine was in the land of Canaan.* Thus the sons of Israel came to buy among the others who came, for the famine was in the land of Canaan.
- 6 *And Joseph was the governor over the land, and he it was that sold to all the people of the land: and Joseph's brethren came, and bowed down themselves before him with their faces to the earth.* Now Joseph was governor over the land. He was the one who sold to all the people of the land. And Joseph's brothers came and bowed themselves before him with their faces to the ground.
- 7 *And Joseph saw his brethren, and he knew them, but made himself strange unto them, and spake roughly unto them; and he said unto them, Whence come ye? And they said, From the land of Canaan to buy food.* Joseph saw his brothers and recognized them. But he treated them like strangers and spoke roughly to them.' 'Where do you come from?' he said. They said, 'From the land of Canaan, to buy food.'
- 8 *And Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him.* Joseph recognized his brothers. But they did not recognize him.
- 9 *And Joseph remembered the dreams which he dreamed of them, and said unto them, Ye are spies; to see the nakedness of the land ye are come.* Joseph remembered the dreams that he had dreamed of them. And he said to them, 'You are spies; you have come to see the nakedness of the land.'
- 10 *And they said unto him, Nay, my lord, but to buy food are thy servants come.* They said to him, 'No, my lord, your servants have come to buy food.'

- 11 *We are all one man's sons; we are true men, thy servants are no spies.* We are all sons of one man. We are honest men. Your servants have never been spies.'
- 12 *And he said unto them, Nay, but to see the nakedness of the land ye are come.* He said to them, 'No, it is the nakedness of the land that you have come to see.'
- 13 *And they said, Thy servants are twelve brethren, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan; and, behold, the youngest is this day with our father, and one is not.* They said, 'We, your servants, are twelve brothers, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan, and the youngest is this day with our father, and one is no more.'
- 14 *And Joseph said unto them, That is it that I spake unto you, saying, Ye are spies:* But Joseph said to them, 'It is as I said to you. You are spies.'
- 15 *Hereby ye shall be proved: By the life of Pharaoh ye shall not go forth hence, except your youngest brother come hither.* By this you shall be tested: by the life of Pharaoh, you shall not go from this place unless your youngest brother comes here.
- 16 *Send one of you, and let him fetch your brother, and ye shall be kept in prison, that your words may be proved, whether there be any truth in you: or else by the life of Pharaoh surely ye are spies.* Send one of you, and let him bring your brother, while you remain confined, that your words may be tested, whether there is truth in you. Or else, by the life of Pharaoh, surely you are spies.'
- 17 *And he put them all together into ward three days.* He put them all together in custody for three days.
- 18 *And Joseph said unto them the third day, This do, and live; for I fear God:* On the third day Joseph said to them, 'Do this and you will live, for I fear God.'
- 19 *If ye be true men, let one of your brethren be bound in the house of your prison: go ye, carry corn for the famine of your houses:* If you are honest men, let one of your brothers remain confined where you are in custody, and let the rest go and carry grain for the famine of your households,

- 20 *But bring your youngest brother unto me; so shall your words be verified, and ye shall not die. And they did so.* bring your youngest brother to me. So your words will be verified, and you shall not die.' And they did so.
- 21 *And they said one to another, We are verily guilty concerning our brother, in that we saw the anguish of his soul, when he besought us, and we would not hear; therefore is this distress come upon us.* Then they said to one another, 'In truth we are guilty concerning our brother, in that we saw the distress of his soul when he begged us and we did not listen. That is why this distress has come upon us.'
- 22 *And Reuben answered them, saying, Spake I not unto you, saying, Do not sin against the child; and ye would not hear? therefore, behold, also his blood is required.* Reuben answered them, 'Did I not tell you not to sin against the boy? But you did not listen. So now there comes a reckoning for his blood.'
- 23 *And they knew not that Joseph understood them; for he spake unto them by an interpreter.* They did not know that Joseph understood them, for there was an interpreter between them.
- 24 *And he turned himself about from them, and wept; and returned to them again, and communed with them, and took from them Simeon, and bound him before their eyes.* Then he turned away from them and wept. And he returned to them and spoke to them. And he took Simeon from them and bound him before their eyes.
- 25 *Then Joseph commanded to fill their sacks with corn, and to restore every man's money into his sack, and to give them provision for the way: and thus did he unto them.* Joseph gave orders to fill their bags with grain, and to replace every man's money in his sack, and to give them provisions for the journey. This was done for them.
- 26 *And they laded their asses with the corn, and departed thence.* Then they loaded their donkeys with their grain and departed.
- 27 *And as one of them opened his sack to give his ass provender in the inn, he espied his money; for, behold, it was in his sack's mouth.* as one of them opened his sack to give his donkey fodder at the lodging place, he saw his money in the mouth of his sack.

- 28 *And he said unto his brethren, My money is restored; and, lo, it is even in my sack: and their heart failed them, and they were afraid, saying one to another, What is this that God hath done unto us?* He said to his brothers, 'My money has been put back; here it is in the mouth of my sack!' At this their hearts failed them. They turned trembling to one another, saying, 'What is this that God has done to us?'
- 29 *And they came unto Jacob their father unto the land of Canaan, and told him all that befell unto them; saying,* When they came to Jacob their father in the land of Canaan, they told him all that had happened to them, saying,
- 30 *The man, who is the lord of the land, spake roughly to us, and took us for spies of the country.* 'The man, the lord of the land, spoke roughly to us and took us to be spies of the land.
- 31 *And we said unto him, We are true men; we are no spies:* But we said to him, We are honest men; we have never been spies.
- 32 *We be twelve brethren, sons of our father; one is not, and the youngest is this day with our father in the land of Canaan.* We are twelve brothers, sons of our father. One is no more, and the youngest is this day with our father in the land of Canaan.
- 33 *And the man, the lord of the country, said unto us, Hereby shall I know that ye are true men; leave one of your brethren here with me, and take food for the famine of your households, and be gone:* Then the man, the lord of the land, said to us, By this I shall know that you are honest men: leave one of your brothers with me, and take grain for the famine of your households and go your way.
- 34 *And bring your youngest brother unto me: then shall I know that ye are no spies, but that ye are true men: so will I deliver you your brother, and ye shall traffick in the land.* Bring your youngest brother to me. Then I shall know that you are not spies but honest men. I will deliver your brother to you, and you shall trade in the land.'
- 35 *And it came to pass as they emptied their sacks, that, behold, every man's bundle of money was in his sack: and when both they and their father saw the bundles of money, they were afraid.* As they emptied their sacks, every man's bundle of money was in his sack. And when they and their father saw their bundles of money, they were afraid.

- 36 *And Jacob their father said unto them, Me have ye bereaved of my children: Joseph is not, and Simeon is not, and ye will take Benjamin away: all these things are against me.* Jacob their father said to them, 'You have bereaved me of my children: Joseph is no more, and Simeon is no more, and now you would take Benjamin. All this has come against me.'
- 37 *And Reuben spake unto his father, saying, Slay my two sons, if I bring him not to thee: deliver him into my hand, and I will bring him to thee again.* Then Reuben said to his father, 'Kill my two sons if I do not bring him back to you. Put him in my hands. I will bring him back to you.'
- 38 *And he said, My son shall not go down with you; for his brother is dead, and he is left alone: if mischief befall him by the way in the which ye go, then shall ye bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to the grave.* But he said, 'My son shall not go down with you, for his brother is dead. He is the only one left. If harm should happen to him on the journey that you are to make, you would bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to the grave.'

Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 7:12
- v2 — Gen 43:8
- v4 — Gen 42:38
- v13 — Gen 37:30
- v18 — Lev 25:43; Neh 5:15
- v20 — Gen 43:5; Gen 42:34; Gen 44:23
- v21 — Hos 5:15
- v22 — 1 Kgs 2:32; 2 Chr 24:22; Ps 9:12
- v33 — Gen 42:19-20
- v34 — Gen 34:10
- v36 — Gen 43:14
- v38 — Gen 37:35; Gen 37:33; Gen 42:4

Chapter 43

When the grain ran out, Judah persuaded Jacob to let Benjamin go to Egypt with them, pledging his own life as surety. Joseph saw Benjamin, had them brought to his house, released Simeon, and hosted a feast where Benjamin received five times the portion of the others.

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| 1 | <i>And the famine was sore in the land.</i> | Now the famine was severe in the land. |
| 2 | <i>And it came to pass, when they had eaten up the corn which they had brought out of Egypt, their father said unto them, Go again, buy us a little food.</i> | When they had eaten the grain that they had brought from Egypt, their father said to them, 'Go again, buy us a little food.' |
| 3 | <i>And Judah spake unto him, saying, The man did solemnly protest unto us, saying, Ye shall not see my face, except your brother be with you.</i> | But Judah said to him, 'The man solemnly warned us, saying, you shall not see my face unless your brother is with you.' |
| 4 | <i>If thou wilt send our brother with us, we will go down and buy thee food:</i> | If you will send our brother with us, we will go down and buy you food. |
| 5 | <i>But if thou wilt not send him, we will not go down: for the man said unto us, Ye shall not see my face, except your brother be with you.</i> | But if you will not send him, we will not go down, for the man said to us, you shall not see my face unless your brother is with you.' |
| 6 | <i>And Israel said, Wherefore dealt ye so ill with me, as to tell the man whether ye had yet a brother?</i> | Israel said, 'Why did you treat me so badly by telling the man that you had another brother?' |
| 7 | <i>And they said, The man asked us straitly of our state, and of our kindred, saying, Is your father yet alive? have ye another brother? and we told him according to the tenor of these words: could we certainly know that he would say, Bring your brother down?</i> | They replied, 'The man questioned us carefully about ourselves and our family, saying, Is your father still alive? Do you have another brother? What we told him was in answer to these questions. Could we in any way know that he would say, Bring your brother down?' |

- 8 *And Judah said unto Israel his father, Send the lad with me, and we will arise and go; that we may live, and not die, both we, and thou, and also our little ones.* Judah said to Israel his father, 'Send the boy with me. We will arise and go, that we may live and not die, both we and you and also our little ones.
- 9 *I will be surety for him; of my hand shalt thou require him: if I bring him not unto thee, and set him before thee, then let me bear the blame for ever:* I will be a pledge of his safety. From my hand you shall require him. If I do not bring him back to you and set him before you, then let me bear the blame forever.
- 10 *For except we had lingered, surely now we had returned this second time.* If we had not delayed, we would now have returned twice.'
- 11 *And their father Israel said unto them, If it must be so now, do this; take of the best fruits in the land in your vessels, and carry down the man a present, a little balm, and a little honey, spices, and myrrh, nuts, and almonds:* Then their father Israel said to them, 'If it must be so, then do this: take some of the choice fruits of the land in your bags, and carry a present down to the man, a little balm and a little honey, gum, myrrh, pistachio nuts, and almonds.
- 12 *And take double money in your hand; and the money that was brought again in the mouth of your sacks, carry it again in your hand; peradventure it was an oversight:* Take double the money with you. Carry back with you the money that was returned in the mouth of your sacks. Perhaps it was an oversight.
- 13 *Take also your brother, and arise, go again unto the man:* Take also your brother, and arise, go again to the man.
- 14 *And God Almighty give you mercy before the man, that he may send away your other brother, and Benjamin. If I be bereaved of my children, I am bereaved.* May God Almighty grant you mercy before the man, and may he send back your other brother and Benjamin. And as for me, if I am bereaved of my children, I am bereaved.'

- 15 *And the men took that present, and they took double money in their hand, and Benjamin; and rose up, and went down to Egypt, and stood before Joseph.* So the men took this present. They took double the money with them, and Benjamin. They arose and went down to Egypt and stood before Joseph.
- 16 *And when Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the ruler of his house, Bring these men home, and slay, and make ready; for these men shall dine with me at noon.* When Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the steward of his house, 'Bring the men into the house, and slaughter an animal and make ready, for the men are to dine with me at noon.'
- 17 *And the man did as Joseph bade; and the man brought the men into Joseph's house.* The man did as Joseph told him and brought the men to Joseph's house.
- 18 *And the men were afraid, because they were brought into Joseph's house; and they said, Because of the money that was returned in our sacks at the first time are we brought in; that he may seek occasion against us, and fall upon us, and take us for bondmen, and our asses.* The men were afraid because they were brought to Joseph's house. They said, 'It is because of the money, which was replaced in our sacks the first time, that we are brought in, so that he may assault us and fall upon us to make us servants and seize our donkeys.'
- 19 *And they came near to the steward of Joseph's house, and they communed with him at the door of the house,* So they went up to the steward of Joseph's house and spoke with him at the door of the house,
- 20 *And said, O sir, we came indeed down at the first time to buy food:* They said, 'Oh, my lord, we came down the first time to buy food.
- 21 *And it came to pass, when we came to the inn, that we opened our sacks, and, behold, every man's money was in the mouth of his sack, our money in full weight: and we have brought it again in our hand.* when we came to the lodging place we opened our sacks, and there was each man's money in the mouth of his sack, our money in full weight. So we have brought it again with us,

- 22 *And other money have we brought down in our hands to buy food: we cannot tell who put our money in our sacks.* we have brought other money down with us to buy food. We do not know who put our money in our sacks.'
- 23 *And he said, Peace be to you, fear not: your God, and the God of your father, hath given you treasure in your sacks: I had your money. And he brought Simeon out unto them.* He replied, 'Peace to you, do not be afraid. Your God and the God of your father has put treasure in your sacks for you. I received your money.' Then He brought Simeon out to them.
- 24 *And the man brought the men into Joseph's house, and gave them water, and they washed their feet; and he gave their asses provender.* When the man had brought the men into Joseph's house and given them water, They had washed their feet, and when he had given their donkeys fodder,
- 25 *And they made ready the present against Joseph came at noon: for they heard that they should eat bread there.* they prepared the present for Joseph's coming at noon, for they heard that they should eat bread there.
- 26 *And when Joseph came home, they brought him the present which was in their hand into the house, and bowed themselves to him to the earth.* When Joseph came home, they brought into the house to him the present that they had with them and bowed down to him to the ground.
- 27 *And he asked them of their welfare, and said, Is your father well, the old man of whom ye spake? Is he yet alive?* he inquired about their welfare and said, 'Is your father well, the old man of whom you spoke? Is he still alive?'
- 28 *And they answered, Thy servant our father is in good health, he is yet alive. And they bowed down their heads, and made obeisance.* They said, 'Your servant our father is well; he is still alive.' And they bowed their heads and prostrated themselves.

- 29 *And he lifted up his eyes, and saw his brother Benjamin, his mother's son, and said, Is this your younger brother, of whom ye spake unto me? And he said, God be gracious unto thee, my son.* he lifted up his eyes and saw his brother Benjamin, his mother's son, and said, 'Is this your youngest brother, of whom you spoke to me? God be gracious to you, my son!'
- 30 *And Joseph made haste; for his bowels did yearn upon his brother: and he sought where to weep; and he entered into his chamber, and wept there.* Then Joseph hurried out, for his compassion grew warm for his brother. He sought a place to weep. And he entered his chamber and wept there.
- 31 *And he washed his face, and went out, and refrained himself, and said, Set on bread.* Then he washed his face and came out. And controlling himself he said, 'Serve the food.'
- 32 *And they set on for him by himself, and for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians, which did eat with him, by themselves: because the Egyptians might not eat bread with the Hebrews; for that is an abomination unto the Egyptians.* They served him by himself, and them by themselves, and the Egyptians who ate with him by themselves, because the Egyptians could not eat with the Hebrews, for that is an abomination to the Egyptians.
- 33 *And they sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright, and the youngest according to his youth: and the men marvelled one at another.* they sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright and the youngest according to his youth. And the men looked at one another in amazement.
- 34 *And he took and sent messes unto them from before him: but Benjamin's mess was five times so much as any of theirs. And they drank, and were merry with him.* Portions were taken to them from Joseph's table, but Benjamin's portion was five times as much as any of theirs. And they drank and were merry with him.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (JOO-dah) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v3** — Gen 44:23
v8 — Gen 42:2
v9 — Gen 42:37
v11 — Gen 37:25
v12 — Gen 42:25
v14 — Esth 4:16; Gen 17:1; Acts 21:14; Neh 1:11; Prov 16:7
v16 — Gen 44:1
v23 — John 20:26; Gen 42:24; John 14:27
v24 — Gen 18:4
v30 — Gen 42:24
v31 — Gen 45:1
v32 — Gen 46:34; Ex 8:26

Chapter 44

Joseph planted his silver cup in Benjamin's sack and sent his steward to overtake the brothers; when the cup was found, all the brothers returned to Joseph's house in dismay. Judah delivered an impassioned plea, recounting Jacob's love for Benjamin and offering himself as a slave in Benjamin's place so the boy could return to their father.

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| <p>1 <i>And he commanded the steward of his house, saying, Fill the men's sacks with food, as much as they can carry, and put every man's money in his sack's mouth.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And put my cup, the silver cup, in the sack's mouth of the youngest, and his corn money. And he did according to the word that Joseph had spoken.</i></p> <p>3 <i>As soon as the morning was light, the men were sent away, they and their asses.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And when they were gone out of the city, and not yet far off, Joseph said unto his steward, Up, follow after the men; and when thou dost overtake them, say unto them, Wherefore have ye rewarded evil for good?</i></p> | <p>Then he commanded the steward of his house, 'Fill the men's sacks with food, as much as they can carry, and put each man's money in the mouth of his sack,</p> <p>put my cup, the silver cup, in the mouth of the sack of the youngest, with his money for the grain.' And he did as Joseph told him.</p> <p>As soon as the morning was light, the men were sent away with their donkeys.</p> <p>They had gone only a short distance from the city. Now Joseph said to his steward, 'Up, follow after the men, and when you overtake them, say to them, Why have you repaid evil for good?</p> |
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| 5 | <i>Is not this it in which my lord drinketh, and whereby indeed he divineth? ye have done evil in so doing.</i> | Is it not from this that my lord drinks, and by this that he practices divination? You have done evil in doing this.' |
| 6 | <i>And he overtook them, and he spake unto them these same words.</i> | When he overtook them, he spoke to them these words. |
| 7 | <i>And they said unto him, Wherefore saith my lord these words? God forbid that thy servants should do according to this thing:</i> | They said to him, 'Why does my lord speak such words as these? Far be it from your servants to do such a thing! |
| 8 | <i>Behold, the money, which we found in our sacks' mouths, we brought again unto thee out of the land of Canaan: how then should we steal out of thy lord's house silver or gold?</i> | the money that we found in the mouths of our sacks we brought back to you from the land of Canaan. How then should we steal silver or gold from your lord's house? |
| 9 | <i>With whomsoever of thy servants it be found, both let him die, and we also will be my lord's bondmen.</i> | Whichever of your servants is found with it shall die. We also will be my lord's servants.' |
| 10 | <i>And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless.</i> | He said, 'Let it be as you say: he who is found with it shall be my servant, and the rest of you shall be innocent.' |
| 11 | <i>Then they speedily took down every man his sack to the ground, and opened every man his sack.</i> | Then each man quickly lowered his sack to the ground, and each man opened his sack. |
| 12 | <i>And he searched, and began at the eldest, and left at the youngest: and the cup was found in Benjamin's sack.</i> | He searched, beginning with the eldest and ending with the youngest. And the cup was found in Benjamin's sack. |
| 13 | <i>Then they rent their clothes, and laded every man his ass, and returned to the city.</i> | Then they tore their clothes, and every man loaded his donkey. They returned to the city. |

- 14 *And Judah and his brethren came to Joseph's house; for he was yet there: and they fell before him on the ground.* When Judah and his brothers came to Joseph's house, he was still there. They fell before him to the ground.
- 15 *And Joseph said unto them, What deed is this that ye have done? wot ye not that such a man as I can certainly divine?* Joseph said to them, 'What deed is this that you have done? Do you not know that a man like me can indeed practice divination?'
- 16 *And Judah said, What shall we say unto my lord? what shall we speak? or how shall we clear ourselves? God hath found out the iniquity of thy servants: behold, we are my lord's servants, both we, and he also with whom the cup is found.* Judah said, 'What shall we say to my lord? What shall we speak? Or how can we clear ourselves? God has found out the guilt of your servants; we are my lord's servants, both we and He also in whose hand the cup has been found.'
- 17 *And he said, God forbid that I should do so: but the man in whose hand the cup is found, he shall be my servant; and as for you, get you up in peace unto your father.* But he said, 'Far be it from me that I should do so! Only the man in whose hand the cup was found shall be my servant. But as for you, go up in peace to your father.'
- 18 *Then Judah came near unto him, and said, Oh my lord, let thy servant, I pray thee, speak a word in my lord's ears, and let not thine anger burn against thy servant: for thou art even as Pharaoh.* Then Judah went up to him and said, 'Oh, my lord, please let your servant speak a word in my lord's ears, and let not your anger burn against your servant, for you are like Pharaoh himself.'
- 19 *My lord asked his servants, saying, Have ye a father, or a brother?* My lord asked his servants, saying, 'Have you a father, or a brother?'
- 20 *And we said unto my lord, We have a father, an old man, and a child of his old age, a little one; and his brother is dead, and he alone is left of his mother, and his father loveth him.* we said to my lord, We have a father, an old man, and a young brother, the child of his old age. His brother is dead. He alone is left of his mother's children. His father loves him.

- 21 *And thou saidst unto thy servants, Bring him down unto me, that I may set mine eyes upon him.* Then you said to your servants, Bring him down to me, that I may set my eyes on him.
- 22 *And we said unto my lord, The lad cannot leave his father: for if he should leave his father, his father would die.* We said to my lord, The boy cannot leave his father, for if he should leave his father, his father would die.
- 23 *And thou saidst unto thy servants, Except your youngest brother come down with you, ye shall see my face no more.* Then you said to your servants, Unless your youngest brother comes down with you, you shall not see my face again.
- 24 *And it came to pass when we came up unto thy servant my father, we told him the words of my lord.* When we went back to your servant my father, we told him the words of my lord.
- 25 *And our father said, Go again, and buy us a little food.* when our father said, Go again, buy us a little food,
- 26 *And we said, We cannot go down: if our youngest brother be with us, then will we go down: for we may not see the man's face, except our youngest brother be with us.* we said, We cannot go down. If our youngest brother goes with us, then we will go down. For we cannot see the man's face unless our youngest brother is with us.
- 27 *And thy servant my father said unto us, Ye know that my wife bare me two sons:* Then your servant my father said to us, You know that my wife bore me two sons.
- 28 *And the one went out from me, and I said, Surely he is torn in pieces; and I saw him not since:* One left me. I said, Surely he has been torn to pieces. I have never seen him since.
- 29 *And if ye take this also from me, and mischief befall him, ye shall bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to the grave.* If you take this one also from me, and harm happens to him, you will bring down my gray hairs in sorrow to the grave.

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| <p>30 <i>Now therefore when I come to thy servant my father, and the lad be not with us; seeing that his life is bound up in the lad's life;</i></p> <p>31 <i>It shall come to pass, when he seeth that the lad is not with us, that he will die: and thy servants shall bring down the gray hairs of thy servant our father with sorrow to the grave.</i></p> <p>32 <i>For thy servant became surety for the lad unto my father, saying, If I bring him not unto thee, then I shall bear the blame to my father for ever.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Now therefore, I pray thee, let thy servant abide instead of the lad a bondman to my lord; and let the lad go up with his brethren.</i></p> <p>34 <i>For how shall I go up to my father, and the lad be not with me? lest peradventure I see the evil that shall come on my father.</i></p> | <p>Now therefore, as soon as I come to your servant my father, and the boy is not with us, then, as his life is bound up in the boy's life,</p> <p>as soon as he sees that the boy is not with us, he will die, and your servants will bring down the gray hairs of your servant our father with sorrow to the grave.</p> <p>For your servant became a pledge of safety for the boy to my father, saying, If I do not bring him back to you, then I shall bear the blame before my father all my life.</p> <p>Now therefore, please let your servant remain instead of the boy as a servant to my lord, and let the boy go back with his brothers.</p> <p>For how can I go back to my father if the boy is not with me? I fear to see the evil that would find my father.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 42:25
- v5** — 2 Kgs 21:6; Gen 30:27; Lev 19:26
- v9** — Gen 31:32
- v13** — 2 Sam 1:11
- v16** — Gen 44:9
- v18** — Ex 32:22
- v20** — Gen 37:3
- v21** — Gen 42:15
- v25** — Gen 43:2
- v27** — Gen 46:19

v29 — Gen 42:38

v33 — 1 John 3:16

Chapter 45

Joseph could no longer restrain himself and revealed his identity to his brothers, weeping aloud, telling them not to be angry with themselves because God had sent him ahead to preserve life during the famine. Pharaoh invited the whole family to settle in the best of Egypt's land, and the brothers returned to Canaan with wagons and gifts to bring Jacob down to Egypt.

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| 1 | <i>Then Joseph could not refrain himself before all them that stood by him; and he cried, Cause every man to go out from me. And there stood no man with him, while Joseph made himself known unto his brethren.</i> | Then Joseph could not control himself before all those who stood by him. He cried, 'Make everyone go out from me.' So no one stayed with him when Joseph made himself known to his brothers. |
| 2 | <i>And he wept aloud: and the Egyptians and the house of Pharaoh heard.</i> | He wept aloud, so that the Egyptians heard it, and the household of Pharaoh heard it. |
| 3 | <i>And Joseph said unto his brethren, I am Joseph; doth my father yet live? And his brethren could not answer him; for they were troubled at his presence.</i> | Joseph said to his brothers, 'I am Joseph! Is my father still alive?' But his brothers could not answer him, for they were dismayed at his presence. |
| 4 | <i>And Joseph said unto his brethren, Come near to me, I pray you. And they came near. And he said, I am Joseph your brother, whom ye sold into Egypt.</i> | So Joseph said to his brothers, 'Come near to me, please.' And they came near. And he said, 'I am your brother, Joseph, whom you sold into Egypt.' |
| 5 | <i>Now therefore be not grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that ye sold me hither: for God did send me before you to preserve life.</i> | Now do not be distressed or angry with yourselves because you sold me here, for God sent me before you to preserve life. |
| 6 | <i>For these two years hath the famine been in the land: and yet there are five years, in the which there shall neither be earing nor harvest.</i> | For the famine has been in the land these two years, and there are yet five years in which there will be neither plowing nor harvest. |

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| 7 | <i>And God sent me before you to preserve you a posterity in the earth, and to save your lives by a great deliverance.</i> | God sent me before you to preserve for you a remnant on earth, and to keep alive for you many survivors. |
| 8 | <i>So now it was not you that sent me hither, but God: and he hath made me a father to Pharaoh, and lord of all his house, and a ruler throughout all the land of Egypt.</i> | So it was not you who sent me here, but God. He has made me a father to Pharaoh, and lord of all his house and ruler over all the land of Egypt. |
| 9 | <i>Haste ye, and go up to my father, and say unto him, Thus saith thy son Joseph, God hath made me lord of all Egypt: come down unto me, tarry not:</i> | Hurry and go up to my father and say to him, Thus says your son Joseph, God has made me lord of all Egypt. Come down to me; do not wait. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Goshen (GO-shen) — "Drawing near" Fertile region in the eastern Nile delta where Jacob's family settled. Home to Israel for 400 years until the Exodus.

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| 10 | <i>And thou shalt dwell in the land of Goshen, and thou shalt be near unto me, thou, and thy children, and thy children's children, and thy flocks, and thy herds, and all that thou hast:</i> | You shall dwell in the land of Goshen, and you shall be near me, you and your children and your children's children, and your flocks, your herds, and all that you have. |
| 11 | <i>And there will I nourish thee; for yet there are five years of famine; lest thou, and thy household, and all that thou hast, come to poverty.</i> | There I will provide for you, for there are yet five years of famine to come, so that you and your household and all that you have do not come to poverty. |
| 12 | <i>And, behold, your eyes see, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin, that it is my mouth that speaketh unto you.</i> | now your eyes see, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin see, that it is my mouth that speaks to you. |
| 13 | <i>And ye shall tell my father of all my glory in Egypt, and of all that ye have seen; and ye shall haste and bring down my father hither.</i> | You must tell my father of all my honor in Egypt, and of all that you have seen. Hurry and bring my father down here.' |
| 14 | <i>And he fell upon his brother Benjamin's neck, and wept; and Benjamin wept upon his neck.</i> | Then he fell upon his brother Benjamin's neck and wept, and Benjamin wept upon his neck. |

- 15 *Moreover he kissed all his brethren, and wept upon them: and after that his brethren talked with him.* he kissed all his brothers and wept upon them. After that his brothers talked with him.
- 16 *And the fame thereof was heard in Pharaoh's house, saying, Joseph's brethren are come: and it pleased Pharaoh well, and his servants.* When the report was heard in Pharaoh's house, 'Joseph's brothers have come,' it pleased Pharaoh and his servants.
- 17 *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Say unto thy brethren, This do ye; lade your beasts, and go, get you unto the land of Canaan;* Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'Say to your brothers, Do this: load your beasts and go back to the land of Canaan,
- 18 *And take your father and your households, and come unto me: and I will give you the good of the land of Egypt, and ye shall eat the fat of the land.* take your father and your households, and come to me. I will give you the best of the land of Egypt, and you shall eat the fat of the land.
- 19 *Now thou art commanded, this do ye; take you wagons out of the land of Egypt for your little ones, and for your wives, and bring your father, and come.* you, Joseph, are commanded to say, Do this: take wagons from the land of Egypt for your little ones and for your wives, and bring your father, and come.
- 20 *Also regard not your stuff; for the good of all the land of Egypt is your's.* Have no concern for your goods, for the best of all the land of Egypt is yours.'
- 21 *And the children of Israel did so: and Joseph gave them wagons, according to the commandment of Pharaoh, and gave them provision for the way.* The sons of Israel did so. Joseph gave them wagons, according to the command of Pharaoh, and gave them provisions for the journey.
- 22 *To all of them he gave each man changes of raiment; but to Benjamin he gave three hundred pieces of silver, and five changes of raiment.* To each of them he gave a change of clothes, but to Benjamin he gave three hundred shekels of silver and five changes of clothes.

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| <p>23 <i>And to his father he sent after this manner; ten asses laden with the good things of Egypt, and ten she asses laden with corn and bread and meat for his father by the way.</i></p> <p>24 <i>So he sent his brethren away, and they departed: and he said unto them, See that ye fall not out by the way.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And they went up out of Egypt, and came into the land of Canaan unto Jacob their father,</i></p> <p>26 <i>And told him, saying, Joseph is yet alive, and he is governor over all the land of Egypt. And Jacob's heart fainted, for he believed them not.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And they told him all the words of Joseph, which he had said unto them: and when he saw the wagons which Joseph had sent to carry him, the spirit of Jacob their father revived:</i></p> <p>28 <i>And Israel said, It is enough; Joseph my son is yet alive: I will go and see him before I die.</i></p> | <p>To his father he sent as follows: ten donkeys loaded with the good things of Egypt, and ten female donkeys loaded with grain, bread, and provision for his father on the journey.</p> <p>Then he sent his brothers away, and as they departed, he said to them, 'Do not quarrel on the way.'</p> <p>So they went up out of Egypt and came to the land of Canaan to their father Jacob.</p> <p>they told him, 'Joseph is still alive. He is ruler over all the land of Egypt.' And his heart became numb, for he did not believe them.</p> <p>But when they told him all the words of Joseph, which he had said to them, and when he saw the wagons that Joseph had sent to carry him, the spirit of their father Jacob revived.</p> <p>Israel said, 'It is enough; Joseph my son is still alive. I will go and see him before I die.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Goshen (*GO-shen*) — The region of Egypt where the Israelites settled at Joseph's invitation — a fertile land in the eastern Nile delta; they remained there during the plagues while Egypt suffered.

Cross-References:

v3 — Acts 7:13

v4 — Gen 37:28

v5 — Gen 50:20; Acts 7:9-15; Gen 45:7-8; Job 1:21; Acts 2:23-24

v8 — John 15:16; Rom 9:16; John 19:11

v10 — Ex 8:22; Ex 9:26

v11 — Gen 47:12

v12 — Gen 42:23

v13 — Acts 7:14

v15 — Luke 15:20

v18 — Num 18:12; Gen 47:6; Gen 27:28

v19 — Gen 46:5

v21 — Gen 45:19

Chapter 46

The descendants of Israel who went down to Egypt are listed, seventy persons in all, organized by the sons of Leah, Zilpah, Rachel, and Bilhah. God spoke to Jacob at Beersheba, promising to make him a great nation in Egypt, and Joseph met his father in Goshen where they wept together.

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| <p>1 <i>And Israel took his journey with all that he had, and came to Beersheba, and offered sacrifices unto the God of his father Isaac.</i></p> | <p>So Israel took his journey with all that he had and came to Beersheba, and offered sacrifices to the God of His father Isaac.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And God spake unto Israel in the visions of the night, and said, Jacob, Jacob. And he said, Here am I.</i></p> | <p>God spoke to Israel in visions of the night and said, 'Jacob, Jacob.' And he said, 'Here I am.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he said, I am God, the God of thy father: fear not to go down into Egypt; for I will there make of thee a great nation:</i></p> | <p>Then he said, 'I am God, the God of your father. Do not be afraid to go down to Egypt, for there I will make you into a great nation.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>I will go down with thee into Egypt; and I will also surely bring thee up again: and Joseph shall put his hand upon thine eyes.</i></p> | <p>I myself will go down with you to Egypt. I will also surely bring you up again. And Joseph's hand shall close your eyes.'</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And Jacob rose up from Beersheba: and the sons of Israel carried Jacob their father, and their little ones, and their wives, in the wagons which Pharaoh had sent to carry him.</i></p> | <p>Then Jacob set out from Beersheba. The sons of Israel carried Jacob their father, their little ones and their wives, in the wagons that Pharaoh had sent to carry him.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And they took their cattle, and their goods, which they had gotten in the land of Canaan, and came into Egypt, Jacob, and all his seed with him:</i></p> | <p>They also took their livestock and their goods, which they had acquired in the land of Canaan, and came into Egypt, Jacob and all his seed with him,</p> |

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| <p>7 His sons, and his sons' sons with him, his daughters, and his sons' daughters, and all his seed brought he with him into Egypt.</p> <p>8 And these are the names of the children of Israel, which came into Egypt, Jacob and his sons: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn.</p> <p>9 And the sons of Reuben; Hanoch, and Phallu, and Hezron, and Carmi.</p> <p>10 And the sons of Simeon; Jemuel, and Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanitish woman.</p> | <p>his sons and his sons' sons with him, his daughters and his sons' daughters, and all his seed he brought with him into Egypt.</p> <p>Now these are the names of the descendants of Israel, who came into Egypt, Jacob and his sons. Reuben, Jacob's firstborn,</p> <p>the sons of Reuben: Hanoch, Phallu, Hezron, and Carmi.</p> <p>The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul, the son of a Canaanite woman.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Gershon (GUR-shon) — "Exile, stranger there" Firstborn son of Levi. Ancestor of the Gershonite clan of priests, responsible for the tabernacle coverings. Kohath (KO-hath) — "Assembly, allied" Second son of Levi. Ancestor of Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. The Kohathites carried the ark and holy furniture. Merari (meh-RAR-eye) — "Bitter, sad" Third son of Levi. Ancestor of the Merarite clan responsible for the tabernacle frames and pillars.

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| <p>11 And the sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.</p> | <p>The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Hezron (HEZ-ron) — "Enclosure, courtyard" Son of Perez (Pharez) in Judah's line. Named in the genealogy of David and Christ (Ruth 4, Matthew 1).

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| <p>12 And the sons of Judah; Er, and Onan, and Shelah, and Pharez, and Zarah: but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. And the sons of Pharez were Hezron and Hamul.</p> <p>13 And the sons of Issachar; Tola, and Phuvah, and Job, and Shimron.</p> <p>14 And the sons of Zebulun; Sered, and Elon, and Jahleel.</p> | <p>The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, Shelah, Pharez, and Zarah (but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan). And the sons of Pharez were Hezron and Hamul.</p> <p>The sons of Issachar: Tola, Phuvah, Job, and Shimron.</p> <p>The sons of Zebulun: Sered, Elon, and Jahleel.</p> |
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| <p>15 <i>These be the sons of Leah, which she bare unto Jacob in Padanaram, with his daughter Dinah: all the souls of his sons and his daughters were thirty and three.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the sons of Gad; Ziphion, and Haggi, Shuni, and Ezbon, Eri, and Arodi, and Areli.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the sons of Asher; Jimnah, and Ishuah, and Isui, and Beriah, and Serah their sister: and the sons of Beriah; Heber, and Malchiel.</i></p> <p>18 <i>These are the sons of Zilpah, whom Laban gave to Leah his daughter, and these she bare unto Jacob, even sixteen souls.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The sons of Rachel Jacob's wife; Joseph, and Benjamin.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And unto Joseph in the land of Egypt were born Manasseh and Ephraim, which Asenath the daughter of Potipherah priest of On bare unto him.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And the sons of Benjamin were Belah, and Becher, and Ashbel, Gera, and Naaman, Ehi, and Rosh, Muppim, and Huppim, and Ard.</i></p> <p>22 <i>These are the sons of Rachel, which were born to Jacob: all the souls were fourteen.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And the sons of Dan; Hushim.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And the sons of Naphtali; Jahzeel, and Guni, and Jezer, and Shillem.</i></p> | <p>These are the sons of Leah, whom she bore to Jacob in Padanaram, together with his daughter Dinah; altogether his sons and his daughters numbered thirty-three.</p> <p>The sons of Gad: Ziphion, Haggi, Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi, and Areli.</p> <p>The sons of Asher: Jimnah, Ishuah, Isui, Beriah, with Serah their sister. And the sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel.</p> <p>These are the sons of Zilpah, whom Laban gave to Leah his daughter. These she bore to Jacob — sixteen persons.</p> <p>The sons of Rachel, Jacob's wife: Joseph and Benjamin.</p> <p>to Joseph in the land of Egypt were born Manasseh and Ephraim, whom Asenath, the daughter of Potipherah the priest of On, bore to him.</p> <p>the sons of Benjamin: Belah, Becher, Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh, Muppim, Huppim, and Ard.</p> <p>These are the sons of Rachel, who were born to Jacob — fourteen persons in all.</p> <p>The son of Dan: Hushim.</p> <p>The sons of Naphtali: Jahzeel, Guni, Jezer, and Shillem.</p> |
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- 25 *These are the sons of Bilhah, which Laban gave unto Rachel his daughter, and she bare these unto Jacob: all the souls were seven.* These are the sons of Bilhah, whom Laban gave to Rachel his daughter. These she bore to Jacob — seven persons in all.
- 26 *All the souls that came with Jacob into Egypt, which came out of his loins, besides Jacob's sons' wives, all the souls were threescore and six;* All the persons belonging to Jacob who came into Egypt, who were his direct descendants, not counting Jacob's sons' wives, were sixty-six persons in all.
- 27 *And the sons of Joseph, which were born him in Egypt, were two souls: all the souls of the house of Jacob, which came into Egypt, were threescore and ten.* the sons of Joseph, who were born to him in Egypt, were two. All the persons of the house of Jacob who came into Egypt were seventy.
- 28 *And he sent Judah before him unto Joseph, to direct his face unto Goshen; and they came into the land of Goshen.* Israel sent Judah ahead of him to Joseph, to show the way before him in Goshen. And they came into the land of Goshen.
- 29 *And Joseph made ready his chariot, and went up to meet Israel his father, to Goshen, and presented himself unto him; and he fell on his neck, and wept on his neck a good while.* Then Joseph prepared his chariot and went up to meet Israel his father in Goshen. He presented himself to him and fell on his neck and wept on his neck a good while.
- 30 *And Israel said unto Joseph, Now let me die, since I have seen thy face, because thou art yet alive.* Israel said to Joseph, 'Now let me die, since I have seen your face and know that you are still alive.'
- 31 *And Joseph said unto his brethren, and unto his father's house, I will go up, and shew Pharaoh, and say unto him, My brethren, and my father's house, which were in the land of Canaan, are come unto me;* Joseph said to his brothers and to his father's household, 'I will go up and tell Pharaoh and will say to him, My brothers and my father's household, who were in the land of Canaan, have come to me.'

- 32 *And the men are shepherds, for their trade hath been to feed cattle; and they have brought their flocks, and their herds, and all that they have.* the men are shepherds, for they have been keepers of livestock. They have brought their flocks and their herds and all that they have.
- 33 *And it shall come to pass, when Pharaoh shall call you, and shall say, What is your occupation?* When Pharaoh calls you and says, What is your occupation?
- 34 *That ye shall say, Thy servants' trade hath been about cattle from our youth even until now, both we, and also our fathers: that ye may dwell in the land of Goshen; for every shepherd is an abomination unto the Egyptians.* you shall say, Your servants have been keepers of livestock from our youth even until now, both we and our fathers, in order that you may dwell in the land of Goshen; for every shepherd is an abomination to the Egyptians.'

Words in this chapter:

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Pharez (*FAIR-ez*) — Twin son of Judah and Tamar — ancestor of King David and of Jesus; his name means 'breach' because he broke out first from the womb unexpectedly.

Zarah (*ZAY-rah*) — Twin brother of Pharez, son of Judah and Tamar — the midwife tied a scarlet thread on his hand first, but Pharez was born ahead of him; his name means 'rising' or 'brightness.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 26:22-25; Gen 28:13; Gen 28:10; Gen 31:42; Gen 21:33

v2 — Gen 15:1; Job 33:14-15

v3 — Gen 12:2; Deut 26:5

v4 — Gen 28:15; Ex 3:8; Gen 50:1; Gen 48:21

v5 — Gen 45:19; Gen 45:21

v6 — Isa 52:4; Acts 7:15; Josh 24:4; Ps 105:23

v10 — Ex 6:15

v16 — Num 26:15-17

v20 — Gen 41:50-52

v25 — Gen 29:29

v27 — Deut 10:22; Acts 7:14

v30 — Luke 2:29-30; Gen 45:28

Chapter 47

Joseph presented his family to Pharaoh, who granted them the land of Goshen; Jacob blessed Pharaoh and told him he was 130 years old. As the famine continued, Joseph collected all the money, livestock, and land of Egypt for Pharaoh, establishing a law that one-fifth of all produce belonged to the crown. Jacob lived seventeen years in Egypt and made Joseph swear to bury him in Canaan with his fathers.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Joseph came and told Pharaoh, and said, My father and my brethren, and their flocks, and their herds, and all that they have, are come out of the land of Canaan; and, behold, they are in the land of Goshen.</i></p> | <p>So Joseph went in and told Pharaoh, 'My father and my brothers, with their flocks and herds and all that they possess, have come from the land of Canaan. They are now in the land of Goshen.'</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he took some of his brethren, even five men, and presented them unto Pharaoh.</i></p> | <p>From among his brothers he took five men and presented them to Pharaoh.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Pharaoh said unto his brethren, What is your occupation? And they said unto Pharaoh, Thy servants are shepherds, both we, and also our fathers.</i></p> | <p>Pharaoh said to his brothers, 'What is your occupation?' And they said to Pharaoh, 'Your servants are shepherds, as our fathers were.'</p> |
| <p>4 <i>They said moreover unto Pharaoh, For to sojourn in the land are we come; for thy servants have no pasture for their flocks; for the famine is sore in the land of Canaan: now therefore, we pray thee, let thy servants dwell in the land of Goshen.</i></p> | <p>They said to Pharaoh, 'We have come to stay in the land, for there is no pasture for your servants' flocks, for the famine is severe in the land of Canaan. And now, please let your servants dwell in the land of Goshen.'</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And Pharaoh spake unto Joseph, saying, Thy father and thy brethren are come unto thee:</i></p> | <p>Then Pharaoh said to Joseph, 'Your father and your brothers have come to you.'</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>The land of Egypt is before thee; in the best of the land make thy father and brethren to dwell; in the land of Goshen let them dwell: and if thou knowest any men of activity among them, then make them rulers over my cattle.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And Joseph brought in Jacob his father, and set him before Pharaoh: and Jacob blessed Pharaoh.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Pharaoh said unto Jacob, How old art thou?</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Jacob said unto Pharaoh, The days of the years of my pilgrimage are an hundred and thirty years: few and evil have the days of the years of my life been, and have not attained unto the days of the years of the life of my fathers in the days of their pilgrimage.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Jacob blessed Pharaoh, and went out from before Pharaoh.</i></p> | <p>The land of Egypt is before you. Settle your father and your brothers in the best of the land. Let them dwell in the land of Goshen, and if you know any able men among them, put them in charge of my livestock.'</p> <p>Then Joseph brought in Jacob his father and set him before Pharaoh, and Jacob blessed Pharaoh.</p> <p>Pharaoh said to Jacob, 'How many are the days of the years of your life?'</p> <p>Jacob said to Pharaoh, 'The days of the years of my sojourning are 130 years. Few and evil have been the days of the years of my life. They have not attained to the days of the years of the life of my fathers in the days of their sojourning.'</p> <p>Jacob blessed Pharaoh and went out from the presence of Pharaoh.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Rameses (RAM-uh-seez) — "Son of Ra (Egyptian)" Region in Egypt where Joseph settled Israel, also called the land of Goshen. Later the name of the store city they were forced to build as slaves.*

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| <p>11 <i>And Joseph placed his father and his brethren, and gave them a possession in the land of Egypt, in the best of the land, in the land of Rameses, as Pharaoh had commanded.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Joseph nourished his father, and his brethren, and all his father's household, with bread, according to their families.</i></p> | <p>Then Joseph settled his father and his brothers and gave them a possession in the land of Egypt, in the best of the land, in the land of Rameses, as Pharaoh had commanded.</p> <p>Joseph provided his father, his brothers, and all his father's household with food, according to the number of their dependents.</p> |
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- 13 *And there was no bread in all the land; for the famine was very sore, so that the land of Egypt and all the land of Canaan fainted by reason of the famine.* Now there was no food in all the land, for the famine was very severe, so that the land of Egypt and all the land of Canaan languished by reason of the famine.
- 14 *And Joseph gathered up all the money that was found in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, for the corn which they bought: and Joseph brought the money into Pharaoh's house.* Joseph gathered up all the money that was found in the land of Egypt and in the land of Canaan, in exchange for the grain that they bought. And Joseph brought the money into Pharaoh's house.
- 15 *And when money failed in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, all the Egyptians came unto Joseph, and said, Give us bread: for why should we die in thy presence? for the money faileth.* When the money was all spent in the land of Egypt and in the land of Canaan, all the Egyptians came to Joseph and said, 'Give us food. Why should we die before your eyes? For our money is gone.'
- 16 *And Joseph said, Give your cattle; and I will give you for your cattle, if money fail.* Joseph answered, 'Give your livestock. I will give you food in exchange for your livestock, if your money is gone.'
- 17 *And they brought their cattle unto Joseph: and Joseph gave them bread in exchange for horses, and for the flocks, and for the cattle of the herds, and for the asses: and he fed them with bread for all their cattle for that year.* So they brought their livestock to Joseph, and Joseph gave them food in exchange for the horses, the flocks, the herds, and the donkeys. He supplied them with food in exchange for all their livestock that year.
- 18 *When that year was ended, they came unto him the second year, and said unto him, We will not hide it from my lord, how that our money is spent; my lord also hath our herds of cattle; there is not ought left in the sight of my lord, but our bodies, and our lands:* When that year was ended, they came to him the following year and said to him, 'We will not hide from my lord that our money is all spent. The herds of livestock are my lord's. There is nothing left in the sight of my lord but our bodies and our land.'

- 19 *Wherefore shall we die before thine eyes, both we and our land? buy us and our land for bread, and we and our land will be servants unto Pharaoh: and give us seed, that we may live, and not die, that the land be not desolate.* Why should we die before your eyes, both we and our land? Buy us and our land for food. We with our land will be servants to Pharaoh. And give us seed that we may live and not die, and that the land may not be desolate.'
- 20 *And Joseph bought all the land of Egypt for Pharaoh; for the Egyptians sold every man his field, because the famine prevailed over them: so the land became Pharaoh's.* So Joseph bought all the land of Egypt for Pharaoh, for all the Egyptians sold their fields, because the famine was severe on them. The land became Pharaoh's.
- 21 *And as for the people, he removed them to cities from one end of the borders of Egypt even to the other end thereof.* As for the people, he moved them into the cities from one end of the border of Egypt to the other.
- 22 *Only the land of the priests bought he not; for the priests had a portion assigned them of Pharaoh, and did eat their portion which Pharaoh gave them: wherefore they sold not their lands.* Only the land of the priests he did not buy, for the priests had a fixed allowance from Pharaoh and lived on the allowance that Pharaoh gave them; therefore they did not sell their land.
- 23 *Then Joseph said unto the people, Behold, I have bought you this day and your land for Pharaoh: lo, here is seed for you, and ye shall sow the land.* Then Joseph said to the people, 'I have this day bought you and your land for Pharaoh. Now here is seed for you, and you shall sow the land.
- 24 *And it shall come to pass in the increase, that ye shall give the fifth part unto Pharaoh, and four parts shall be your own, for seed of the field, and for your food, and for them of your households, and for food for your little ones.* at the harvests you shall give a fifth to Pharaoh, and four fifths shall be your own, as seed for the field and as food for yourselves and your households, and as food for your little ones.'

- 25 *And they said, Thou hast saved our lives: let us find grace in the sight of my lord, and we will be Pharaoh's servants.* they said, 'You have saved our lives; may it please my lord, we will be servants to Pharaoh.'
- 26 *And Joseph made it a law over the land of Egypt unto this day, that Pharaoh should have the fifth part; except the land of the priests only, which became not Pharaoh's.* So Joseph made it a statute concerning the land of Egypt. It stands to this day, that Pharaoh should have a fifth; the land of the priests alone did not become Pharaoh's.
- 27 *And Israel dwelt in the land of Egypt, in the country of Goshen; and they had possessions therein, and grew, and multiplied exceedingly.* Thus Israel lived in the land of Egypt, in the land of Goshen. And they gained possessions in it, and were fruitful and multiplied greatly.
- 28 *And Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years: so the whole age of Jacob was an hundred forty and seven years.* Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years. So the days of Jacob, the years of his life, were 147 years.
- 29 *And the time drew nigh that Israel must die: and he called his son Joseph, and said unto him, If now I have found grace in thy sight, put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh, and deal kindly and truly with me; bury me not, I pray thee, in Egypt:* when the time drew near that Israel must die, he called his son Joseph and said to him, 'If now I have found favor in your sight, put your hand under my thigh and deal kindly and truly with me. Do not bury me in Egypt,
- 30 *But I will lie with my fathers, and thou shalt carry me out of Egypt, and bury me in their buryingplace. And he said, I will do as thou hast said.* but let me lie with my fathers. Carry me out of Egypt and bury me in their burying place.' He answered, 'I will do as you have said.'
- 31 *And he said, Swear unto me. And he swore unto him. And Israel bowed himself upon the bed's head.* He said, 'Swear to me.' And he swore to him. Then Israel bowed himself upon the head of his bed.

Words in this chapter:

Goshen (*GO-shen*) — The region of Egypt where the Israelites settled at Joseph's invitation — a fertile land in the eastern Nile delta; they remained there during the plagues while

Egypt suffered.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Gen 46:34; Deut 26:5; Gen 15:13
- v7 — Gen 47:10
- v9 — Job 14:1; Ps 39:12; Ps 39:5; Gen 35:28
- v10 — Gen 47:7
- v11 — Ex 12:37; Ex 1:11; Gen 47:6
- v14 — Gen 41:56
- v22 — Ezra 7:24
- v24 — Gen 41:34
- v26 — Gen 47:22
- v27 — Gen 46:3; Ex 1:7; Acts 7:17
- v29 — Gen 24:2; Gen 24:49; Deut 31:14
- v31 — 1 Kgs 1:47

Chapter 48

Jacob adopted Joseph's two sons Ephraim and Manasseh as his own, giving them equal standing with Reuben and Simeon among the tribes of Israel. When blessing them, Jacob deliberately crossed his hands and placed his right hand on the younger Ephraim's head, declaring that Ephraim would be greater than his older brother Manasseh.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass after these things, that one told Joseph, Behold, thy father is sick: and he took with him his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim.</i> | After this, Joseph was told, 'your father is ill.' So he took with him his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim. |
| 2 | <i>And one told Jacob, and said, Behold, thy son Joseph cometh unto thee: and Israel strengthened himself, and sat upon the bed.</i> | It was told to Jacob, 'Your son Joseph has come to you.' Then Israel summoned his strength and sat up in bed. |
| 3 | <i>And Jacob said unto Joseph, God Almighty appeared unto me at Luz in the land of Canaan, and blessed me,</i> | Jacob said to Joseph, 'God Almighty appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan and blessed me, |
| 4 | <i>And said unto me, Behold, I will make thee fruitful, and multiply thee, and I will make of thee a multitude of people; and will give this land to thy seed after thee for an everlasting possession.</i> | said to me, I will make you fruitful and multiply you, and will make of you a company of peoples and will give this land to your seed after you for an everlasting possession. |

- 5 *And now thy two sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, which were born unto thee in the land of Egypt before I came unto thee into Egypt, are mine; as Reuben and Simeon, they shall be mine.* Now your two sons, who were born to you in the land of Egypt before I came to you in Egypt, are mine. Ephraim and Manasseh shall be mine, as Reuben and Simeon are.
- 6 *And thy issue, which thou begetteth after them, shall be thine, and shall be called after the name of their brethren in their inheritance.* The children that you father after them shall be yours. They shall be called by the name of their brothers in their inheritance.
- 7 *And as for me, when I came from Padan, Rachel died by me in the land of Canaan in the way, when yet there was but a little way to come unto Ephrath: and I buried her there in the way of Ephrath; the same is Bethlehem.* As for me, when I came from Paddan, to my sorrow Rachel died in the land of Canaan on the way, when there was still some distance to go to Ephrath. I buried her there on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem).'
- 8 *And Israel beheld Joseph's sons, and said, Who are these?* When Israel saw Joseph's sons, he said, 'Who are these?'
- 9 *And Joseph said unto his father, They are my sons, whom God hath given me in this place. And he said, Bring them, I pray thee, unto me, and I will bless them.* Joseph said to his father, 'They are my sons, whom God has given me here.' And He said, 'Bring them to me, please, that I may bless them.'
- 10 *Now the eyes of Israel were dim for age, so that he could not see. And he brought them near unto him; and he kissed them, and embraced them.* Now the eyes of Israel were dim with age, so that he could not see. So Joseph brought them near him. He kissed them and embraced them.
- 11 *And Israel said unto Joseph, I had not thought to see thy face: and, lo, God hath shewed me also thy seed.* Israel said to Joseph, 'I never expected to see your face. God has let me see your seed also.'
- 12 *And Joseph brought them out from between his knees, and he bowed himself with his face to the earth.* Then Joseph removed them from his knees and bowed himself with his face to the earth.

- 13 *And Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near unto him.* Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near him.
- 14 *And Israel stretched out his right hand, and laid it upon Ephraim's head, who was the younger, and his left hand upon Manasseh's head, guiding his hands wittingly; for Manasseh was the firstborn.* Israel stretched out his right hand and laid it on the head of Ephraim, who was the younger, and his left hand on the head of Manasseh, crossing his hands intentionally, for Manasseh was the firstborn.
- 15 *And he blessed Joseph, and said, God, before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac did walk, the God which fed me all my life long unto this day,* He blessed Joseph and said, 'The God before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, the God Who has been my shepherd all my life long to this day,
- 16 *The Angel which redeemed me from all evil, bless the lads; and let my name be named on them, and the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac; and let them grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth.* the Angel who has redeemed me from all evil, bless the boys. In them let my name be carried on, and the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac. Let them grow into a crowd in the midst of the earth.'
- 17 *And when Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, it displeased him: and he held up his father's hand, to remove it from Ephraim's head unto Manasseh's head.* When Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand on the head of Ephraim, it displeased him. He took his father's hand to move it from Ephraim's head to Manasseh's head.
- 18 *And Joseph said unto his father, Not so, my father: for this is the firstborn; put thy right hand upon his head.* Joseph said to his father, 'Not this way, my father; since this one is the firstborn, put your right hand on his head.'

- 19 *And his father refused, and said, I know it, my son, I know it: he also shall become a people, and he also shall be great: but truly his younger brother shall be greater than he, and his seed shall become a multitude of nations.* But his father refused and said, 'I know, my son, I know. He also shall become a people. He also shall be great. Nevertheless, his younger brother shall be greater than he. His seed shall become a crowd of nations.'
- 20 *And he blessed them that day, saying, In thee shall Israel bless, saying, God make thee as Ephraim and as Manasseh: and he set Ephraim before Manasseh.* So he blessed them that day, saying, 'By you Israel will pronounce blessings, saying, God make you as Ephraim and as Manasseh.' Thus he put Ephraim before Manasseh.
- 21 *And Israel said unto Joseph, Behold, I die: but God shall be with you, and bring you again unto the land of your fathers.* Then Israel said to Joseph, 'I am about to die. But God will be with you and will bring you again to the land of your fathers.'
- 22 *Moreover I have given to thee one portion above thy brethren, which I took out of the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow.* Moreover, I have given to you rather than to your brothers one mountain slope that I took from the hand of the Amorites with my sword and with my bow.'

Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

v4 — Gen 17:8

v5 — Gen 41:50-52; Gen 46:20; Josh 14:4

v9 — Gen 27:4

v10 — Gen 27:27; Gen 27:1

v11 — Eph 3:20

v15 — Gen 17:1

v16 — Ps 34:22; Gen 48:5; Gen 49:22

v21 — Gen 46:4; Gen 50:24

v22 — John 4:5

Chapter 49

Jacob gathered his twelve sons and pronounced a prophetic blessing on each, rebuking Reuben for his instability, cursing the anger of Simeon and Levi, and exalting Judah with the promise that the scepter would not depart from him until Shiloh come. After blessing the remaining sons — including Joseph with abundant fruitfulness and Benjamin as a ravenous wolf — Jacob commanded them to bury him in the cave of Machpelah, then drew up his feet into the bed and died.

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| 1 <i>And Jacob called unto his sons, and said, Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you that which shall befall you in the last days.</i> | Then Jacob called his sons and said, 'Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you what shall happen to you in days to come. |
| 2 <i>Gather yourselves together, and hear, ye sons of Jacob; and hearken unto Israel your father.</i> | Assemble and listen, O sons of Jacob, listen to Israel your father. |
| 3 <i>Reuben, thou art my firstborn, my might, and the beginning of my strength, the excellency of dignity, and the excellency of power:</i> | Reuben, you are my firstborn, my might, and the firstfruits of my strength, preeminent in dignity and preeminent in power. |
| 4 <i>Unstable as water, thou shalt not excel; because thou wentest up to thy father's bed; then defiledst thou it: he went up to my couch.</i> | Unstable as water, you shall not have preeminence, because you went up to your father's bed; then you defiled it—he went up to my couch! |
| 5 <i>Simeon and Levi are brethren; instruments of cruelty are in their habitations.</i> | Simeon and Levi are brothers; instruments of cruelty are in their habitations. |
| 6 <i>O my soul, come not thou into their secret; unto their assembly, mine honour, be not thou united: for in their anger they slew a man, and in their selfwill they digged down a wall.</i> | Let my soul come not into their council; O my glory, be not joined to their company. For in their anger they killed men, and in their selfwill they digged down a wall. |

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| <p>7 <i>Cursed be their anger, for it was fierce; and their wrath, for it was cruel: I will divide them in Jacob, and scatter them in Israel.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Judah, thou art he whom thy brethren shall praise: thy hand shall be in the neck of thine enemies; thy father's children shall bow down before thee.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Judah is a lion's whelp: from the prey, my son, thou art gone up: he stooped down, he couched as a lion, and as an old lion; who shall rouse him up?</i></p> | <p>Cursed be their anger, for it is fierce. Their wrath, for it is cruel! I will divide them in Jacob and scatter them in Israel.</p> <p>Judah, your brothers shall praise you; your hand shall be on the neck of your enemies; your father's sons shall bow down before you.</p> <p>Judah is a lion's cub; from the prey, my son, you have gone up. He stooped down, he crouched like a lion and like a lioness; who dares rouse him?</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Shiloh (SHY-lo) — "He whose it is, tranquil one, peaceful one" Prophetic title in Jacob's blessing over Judah — 'until Shiloh comes.' Understood by Jews and Christians as a messianic reference; in Christian reading, a prophecy of Christ.

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| <p>10 <i>The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet, until Shiloh come; and unto him shall the gathering of the people be.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Binding his foal unto the vine, and his ass's colt unto the choice vine; he washed his garments in wine, and his clothes in the blood of grapes:</i></p> <p>12 <i>His eyes shall be red with wine, and his teeth white with milk.</i></p> | <p>The scepter shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between His feet, until Shiloh come; and unto Him shall the gathering of the people be.</p> <p>Binding His foal to the vine and his donkey's colt to the choice vine, He has washed His garments in wine and His robes in the blood of grapes.</p> <p>His eyes shall be red with wine, and His teeth white with milk.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Zidon (ZY-don) — "Fishing, hunting" Ancient Phoenician coastal city north of Tyre. Boundary point mentioned in Zebulun's blessing. Also spelled Sidon.

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| <p>13 <i>Zebulun shall dwell at the haven of the sea; and he shall be for an haven of ships; and his border shall be unto Zidon.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Issachar is a strong ass couching down between two burdens:</i></p> | <p>Zebulun shall dwell at the shore of the sea; He shall become a haven for ships. His border shall be at Zidon.</p> <p>Issachar is a strong donkey, crouching between two burdens.</p> |
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| <p>15 <i>And he saw that rest was good, and the land that it was pleasant; and bowed his shoulder to bear, and became a servant unto tribute.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Dan shall judge his people, as one of the tribes of Israel.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Dan shall be a serpent by the way, an adder in the path, that biteth the horse heels, so that his rider shall fall backward.</i></p> <p>18 <i>I have waited for thy salvation, O LORD.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Gad, a troop shall overcome him: but he shall overcome at the last.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Out of Asher his bread shall be fat, and he shall yield royal dainties.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Naphtali is a hind let loose: he giveth goodly words.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Joseph is a fruitful bough, even a fruitful bough by a well; whose branches run over the wall:</i></p> <p>23 <i>The archers have sorely grieved him, and shot at him, and hated him:</i></p> <p>24 <i>But his bow abode in strength, and the arms of his hands were made strong by the hands of the mighty God of Jacob; (from thence is the shepherd, the stone of Israel:)</i></p> <p>25 <i>Even by the God of thy father, who shall help thee; and by the Almighty, who shall bless thee with blessings of heaven above, blessings of the deep that lieth under, blessings of the breasts, and of the womb:</i></p> | <p>He saw that a resting place was good, and that the land was pleasant, so He bowed His shoulder to bear, and became a servant at forced labor.</p> <p>Dan shall judge His people as one of the tribes of Israel.</p> <p>Dan shall be a serpent in the way, a viper by the path, that bites the horse's heels so that His rider falls backward.</p> <p>I wait for Your salvation, O LORD.</p> <p>Raiders shall raid Gad, but He shall overcome at the last.</p> <p>Asher's food shall be rich. He shall yield royal delicacies.</p> <p>Naphtali is a hind let loose that giveth goodly words.</p> <p>Joseph is a fruitful bough, a fruitful bough by a spring; his branches run over the wall.</p> <p>The archers bitterly attacked him, shot at him, and harassed him severely,</p> <p>yet his bow remained unmoved. His arms were made strong by the hands of the Mighty One of Jacob (from there is the Shepherd, the Stone of Israel),</p> <p>by the God of Your father who will help You, by the Almighty Who will bless You with blessings of heaven above, blessings of the deep that crouches beneath, blessings of the breasts and of the womb.</p> |
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- 26 *The blessings of thy father have prevailed above the blessings of my progenitors unto the utmost bound of the everlasting hills: they shall be on the head of Joseph, and on the crown of the head of him that was separate from his brethren.* The blessings of your father are mighty beyond the blessings of my ancestors, up to the bounties of the everlasting hills. May they be on the head of Joseph, and on the brow of him who was set apart from his brothers.
- 27 *Benjamin shall ravin as a wolf: in the morning he shall devour the prey, and at night he shall divide the spoil.* Benjamin is a ravenous wolf, in the morning devouring the prey and at evening dividing the spoil.'
- 28 *All these are the twelve tribes of Israel: and this is it that their father spake unto them, and blessed them; every one according to his blessing he blessed them.* All these are the twelve tribes of Israel. This is what their father said to them as he blessed them; he blessed each with the blessing suitable to him.
- 29 *And he charged them, and said unto them, I am to be gathered unto my people: bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite,* Then he commanded them and said to them, 'I am to be gathered to my people; bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite,
- 30 *In the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, which is before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field of Ephron the Hittite for a possession of a buryingplace.* in the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, to the east of Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field from Ephron the Hittite to possess as a burying place.
- 31 *There they buried Abraham and Sarah his wife; there they buried Isaac and Rebekah his wife; and there I buried Leah.* There Abraham and his wife Sarah were buried; there Isaac and his wife Rebekah were buried. There I buried Leah—
- 32 *The purchase of the field and of the cave that is therein was from the children of Heth.* the field and the cave that is in it were bought from the sons of Heth.'

- 33 *And when Jacob had made an end of commanding his sons, he gathered up his feet into the bed, and yielded up the ghost, and was gathered unto his people.* When Jacob finished commanding his sons, he drew up his feet into the bed and breathed his last and was gathered to his people.

Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 24:14; Dan 10:14; Jer 23:20
 v3 — Ps 78:51; Deut 21:17; Ps 105:36
 v4 — Gen 35:22; 1 Chr 5:1; Deut 27:20; Deut 33:6; 1 Cor 5:1
 v6 — Gen 34:30; Ps 26:9
 v8 — Gen 27:29; Heb 7:14
 v9 — Num 24:9; Rev 5:5; Num 23:24; Mic 5:8
 v10 — Num 24:17; Luke 1:32-33; Isa 9:6; Ps 60:7; Jer 23:5-6
 v14 — Gen 30:18; 1 Chr 12:32
 v18 — Ps 119:166; Ps 119:174; Mic 7:7; Isa 25:9; Ps 130:5
 v20 — Deut 33:24-25; Gen 30:13
 v24 — Ps 132:2; Isa 28:16; Ps 132:5
 v25 — Gen 35:11; Gen 28:13; Phil 4:19; Deut 8:17; Gen 27:28

Chapter 50

Joseph had his father embalmed, and a great company of Egyptians and Israelites carried Jacob's body to Canaan and buried him in the cave of Machpelah. After returning to Egypt, Joseph's brothers feared he would take revenge, but Joseph told them not to fear, declaring that what they meant for evil God meant for good to save many lives. Joseph lived 110 years, saw his great-grandchildren, and before dying made Israel swear to carry his bones out of Egypt when God visited them.

- 1 *And Joseph fell upon his father's face, and wept upon him, and kissed him.* Then Joseph fell on his father's face and wept over him and kissed him.
- 2 *And Joseph commanded his servants the physicians to embalm his father: and the physicians embalmed Israel.* Joseph commanded his servants the physicians to embalm his father. So the physicians embalmed Israel.

- 3 *And forty days were fulfilled for him; for so are fulfilled the days of those which are embalmed: and the Egyptians mourned for him threescore and ten days.* Forty days were required for it, for that is how many are required for embalming. And the Egyptians mourned for him seventy days.
- 4 *And when the days of his mourning were past, Joseph spake unto the house of Pharaoh, saying, If now I have found grace in your eyes, speak, I pray you, in the ears of Pharaoh, saying,* When the days of weeping for him were past, Joseph spoke to the household of Pharaoh, saying, 'If now I have found favor in your eyes, please speak in the ears of Pharaoh, saying,
- 5 *My father made me swear, saying, Lo, I die: in my grave which I have digged for me in the land of Canaan, there shalt thou bury me. Now therefore let me go up, I pray thee, and bury my father, and I will come again.* My father made me swear, saying, I am about to die. In the tomb that I hewed out for myself in the land of Canaan, there you shall bury me. Now therefore, let me please go up and bury my father. Then I will return.'
- 6 *And Pharaoh said, Go up, and bury thy father, according as he made thee swear.* Pharaoh answered, 'Go up, and bury your father, as he made you swear.'
- 7 *And Joseph went up to bury his father: and with him went up all the servants of Pharaoh, the elders of his house, and all the elders of the land of Egypt,* So Joseph went up to bury his father. With him went up all the servants of Pharaoh, the elders of his household, and all the elders of the land of Egypt,
- 8 *And all the house of Joseph, and his brethren, and his father's house: only their little ones, and their flocks, and their herds, they left in the land of Goshen.* as well as all the household of Joseph, his brothers, and his father's household. Only their children, their flocks, and their herds were left in the land of Goshen.
- 9 *And there went up with him both chariots and horsemen: and it was a very great company.* There went up with him both chariots and horsemen. It was a very great company.

■ NAME NOTE Atad (AY-tad) — "Thorn, buckthorn" Threshing floor east of the Jordan where Joseph and the Egyptians mourned Jacob seven days.

- 10 *And they came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is beyond Jordan, and there they mourned with a great and very sore lamentation: and he made a mourning for his father seven days.* When they came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is beyond the Jordan, they lamented there with a very great and grievous lamentation. He made a mourning for his father seven days.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Abelmizraim (AY-bel-MIZ-ray-im) — "Mourning of Egypt" Name the Canaanites gave to the threshing floor of Atad, after witnessing the great Egyptian mourning for Jacob.*

- 11 *And when the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, saw the mourning in the floor of Atad, they said, This is a grievous mourning to the Egyptians: wherefore the name of it was called Abelmizraim, which is beyond Jordan.* When the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, saw the mourning on the threshing floor of Atad, they said, 'This is a grievous mourning by the Egyptians.' Therefore the place was named Abel-mizraim; it is beyond the Jordan.
- 12 *And his sons did unto him according as he commanded them:* Thus his sons did for him as he had commanded them,
- 13 *For his sons carried him into the land of Canaan, and buried him in the cave of the field of Machpelah, which Abraham bought with the field for a possession of a buryingplace of Ephron the Hittite, before Mamre.* For his sons carried him to the land of Canaan and buried him in the cave of the field at Machpelah, to the east of Mamre, which Abraham bought with the field from Ephron the Hittite to possess as a burying place.
- 14 *And Joseph returned into Egypt, he, and his brethren, and all that went up with him to bury his father, after he had buried his father.* After he had buried his father, Joseph returned to Egypt with his brothers and all who had gone up with him to bury his father.
- 15 *And when Joseph's brethren saw that their father was dead, they said, Joseph will peradventure hate us, and will certainly requite us all the evil which we did unto him.* When Joseph's brothers saw that their father was dead, they said, 'It may be that Joseph will hate us and pay us back for all the evil that we did to him.'

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| <p>16 <i>And they sent a messenger unto Joseph, saying, Thy father did command before he died, saying,</i></p> <p>17 <i>So shall ye say unto Joseph, Forgive, I pray thee now, the trespass of thy brethren, and their sin; for they did unto thee evil: and now, we pray thee, forgive the trespass of the servants of the God of thy father. And Joseph wept when they spake unto him.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And his brethren also went and fell down before his face; and they said, Behold, we be thy servants.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Joseph said unto them, Fear not: for am I in the place of God?</i></p> <p>20 <i>But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Now therefore fear ye not: I will nourish you, and your little ones. And he comforted them, and spake kindly unto them.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Joseph dwelt in Egypt, he, and his father's house: and Joseph lived an hundred and ten years.</i></p> | <p>So they sent a message to Joseph, saying, 'Your father gave this command before he died,</p> <p>Say to Joseph, Please forgive the transgression of your brothers and their sin, because they did evil to you. And now, please forgive the transgression of the servants of the God of your father.' Joseph wept when they spoke to him.</p> <p>His brothers also came and fell down before him and said, ' we are your servants.'</p> <p>But Joseph said to them, 'Do not fear, for am I in the place of God?</p> <p>As for you, you meant evil against me. But God meant it for good, to bring it about that many people should be kept alive, as they are today.</p> <p>So do not fear; I will provide for you and your little ones.' Thus he comforted them and spoke kindly to them.</p> <p>So Joseph remained in Egypt, he and his father's house. Joseph lived 110 years.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Machir (MAY-kir) — "Sold, bought" Son of Manasseh, grandson of Joseph. Joseph saw his children on his knees before dying. Later a clan of the tribe of Manasseh.*

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| <p>23 <i>And Joseph saw Ephraim's children of the third generation: the children also of Machir the son of Manasseh were brought up upon Joseph's knees.</i></p> | <p>Joseph saw Ephraim's children of the third generation. The children also of Machir the son of Manasseh were brought up on Joseph's knees.</p> |
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| <p>24 <i>And Joseph said unto his brethren, I die: and God will surely visit you, and bring you out of this land unto the land which he swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And Joseph took an oath of the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you, and ye shall carry up my bones from hence.</i></p> <p>26 <i>So Joseph died, being an hundred and ten years old: and they embalmed him, and the days of Joseph were fulfilled: and they were embalmed in a coffin in Egypt.</i></p> | <p>Joseph said to his brothers, 'I am about to die. But God will surely visit you and bring you up out of this land to the land that He swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.'</p> <p>Then Joseph made the sons of Israel swear, saying, 'God will surely visit you, and you shall carry up my bones from here.'</p> <p>So Joseph died, being 110 years old. They embalmed him. He was put in a coffin in Egypt.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Abel (AY-bel) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Cross-References:

v2 — Gen 50:26; 2 Chr 16:14
v3 — Deut 34:8; Num 20:29
v5 — 2 Chr 16:14; Isa 22:16
v10 — Job 2:13; Acts 8:2; 2 Sam 1:17
v15 — Prov 28:1
v16 — Prov 29:25
v19 — Rom 12:19
v20 — Rom 8:28; Ps 119:71; Gen 45:5-8; Gen 37:18-20; Acts 2:23
v21 — Gen 47:12; 1 Pet 3:9
v23 — Num 32:39; Job 42:16; Gen 30:3
v24 — Ex 3:16-17; Gen 35:12; Gen 26:3; Gen 28:13; Gen 48:21
v25 — Ex 13:19; Josh 24:32; Heb 11:22; Gen 47:29-31; Acts 7:16

Exodus

Author: Moses — he is named as the author within the text itself (Ex 17:14, 24:4, 34:27) and confirmed by Christ (Mark 12:26).

Date written: c. 1445–1405 BC.

Written to: Israel in the wilderness, as a foundational account of how they became a nation.

Setting: Four hundred years after Joseph. Israel has grown into a nation of millions but lives in brutal slavery in Egypt. God is about to act in history more dramatically than at any point since creation.

Where this sits historically: The exodus event itself c. 1446 BC under Egypt's 18th dynasty, with Thutmose III or Amenhotep II as the likely Pharaoh of the oppression and exodus.

Contemporaries: Egypt's New Kingdom — Hatshepsut, Thutmose III, Amenhotep II. Leviticus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy are written by Moses in the same forty-year span.

Big themes:

- Redemption — God rescues His people by power, not their merit; the Exodus is the OT's central redemption event
- The name of God — God reveals Himself as "I AM THAT I AM" and as YHWH (the LORD) for the first time in full
- Passover — the blood of a lamb on the doorpost is the only protection from judgment; it points forward to Christ
- The law — the Ten Commandments and the covenant code define how the redeemed people are to live
- The tabernacle — the last half of Exodus is consumed with exact instructions for God's dwelling place among His people

Key passages: Ex 3:14; 12:13; 20:1–17; 25:8; 33:19

How it fits: The Exodus is the event the entire OT looks back to as proof that God saves. The Passover lamb points to Christ (1 Cor 5:7). The tabernacle instructions anticipate Hebrews' theology of the better sanctuary. Leviticus follows directly with the laws governing worship in that tabernacle.

Chapter 1

The children of Israel multiplied greatly in Egypt after Joseph's death until a new Pharaoh who did not know Joseph arose and enslaved them with bitter labor, forcing them to build the store cities of Pithom and Raamses. When oppression failed to slow their growth, Pharaoh ordered the Hebrew midwives to kill every newborn son, but they feared God and disobeyed; finally Pharaoh commanded all his people to cast every Hebrew son into the Nile.

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| <p>1 <i>Now these are the names of the children of Israel, which came into Egypt; every man and his household came with Jacob.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah,</i></p> <p>3 <i>Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin,</i></p> <p>4 <i>Dan, and Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And all the souls that came out of the loins of Jacob were seventy souls: for Joseph was in Egypt already.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And Joseph died, and all his brethren, and all that generation.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the children of Israel were fruitful, and increased abundantly, and multiplied, and waxed exceeding mighty; and the land was filled with them.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Now there arose up a new king over Egypt, which knew not Joseph.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And he said unto his people, Behold, the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we:</i></p> <p>10 <i>Come on, let us deal wisely with them; lest they multiply, and it come to pass, that, when there falleth out any war, they join also unto our enemies, and fight against us, and so get them up out of the land.</i></p> | <p>These are the names of the sons of Israel who came to Egypt with Jacob, each with his household:</p> <p>Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.</p> <p>All the descendants of Jacob were seventy persons; Joseph was already in Egypt.</p> <p>Then Joseph died, and all his brothers, and all that generation.</p> <p>But the children of Israel were fruitful and increased greatly; they multiplied and grew greatly strong, so that the land was filled with them.</p> <p>Now there arose a new king over Egypt, who did not know Joseph.</p> <p>he said to his people, 'Look, the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we.</p> <p>Come, let us deal shrewdly with them, lest they multiply, and if war breaks out, they join our enemies and fight against us and escape from the land.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Pithom (PIE-thom) — "House of Atum" One of two store cities Israel was forced to build for Pharaoh. Located in the eastern Nile delta. Raamses (RAM-seez) — "Son of Ra" Second store city built by Israelite slaves. Named after the sun god; later the region Israel departed from at the Exodus.*

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| <p>11 <i>Therefore they did set over them taskmasters to afflict them with their burdens. And they built for Pharaoh treasure cities, Pithom and Raamses.</i></p> <p>12 <i>But the more they afflicted them, the more they multiplied and grew. And they were grieved because of the children of Israel.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the Egyptians made the children of Israel to serve with rigour:</i></p> <p>14 <i>And they made their lives bitter with hard bondage, in mortar, and in brick, and in all manner of service in the field: all their service, wherein they made them serve, was with rigour.</i></p> | <p>So they set taskmasters over them to afflict them with heavy burdens. And they built for Pharaoh the store cities Pithom and Raamses.</p> <p>But the more they afflicted them, the more they multiplied and spread. And the Egyptians were in dread of the children of Israel.</p> <p>So the Egyptians made the children of Israel serve with harshness.</p> <p>They made their lives bitter with hard labor in mortar and brick and in all kinds of work in the fields. In all their work they ruthlessly made them serve.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Shiphrah (SHIF-rah) — "Beautiful, fair" One of two Hebrew midwives who defied Pharaoh's order to kill the male newborns. God rewarded her with a household of her own. Puah (POO-ah) — "Splendid, fragrant" Second Hebrew midwife who feared God more than Pharaoh. The midwives are the first recorded acts of civil disobedience for righteousness in Scripture.

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| <p>15 <i>And the king of Egypt spake to the Hebrew midwives, of which the name of the one was Shiphrah, and the name of the other Puah:</i></p> <p>16 <i>And he said, When ye do the office of a midwife to the Hebrew women, and see them upon the stools; if it be a son, then ye shall kill him: but if it be a daughter, then she shall live.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But the midwives feared God, and did not as the king of Egypt commanded them, but saved the men children alive.</i></p> | <p>Then the king of Egypt said to the Hebrew midwives, one of whom was named Shiphrah and the other Puah,</p> <p>'When you serve as midwife to the Hebrew women and see them on the birthstool, if it is a son, you shall kill him, but if it is a daughter, she shall live.'</p> <p>But the midwives feared God and did not do as the king of Egypt commanded them, but let the male children live.</p> |
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| <p>18 <i>And the king of Egypt called for the midwives, and said unto them, Why have ye done this thing, and have saved the men children alive?</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the midwives said unto Pharaoh, Because the Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women; for they are lively, and are delivered ere the midwives come in unto them.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Therefore God dealt well with the midwives: and the people multiplied, and waxed very mighty.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And it came to pass, because the midwives feared God, that he made them houses.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Pharaoh charged all his people, saying, Every son that is born ye shall cast into the river, and every daughter ye shall save alive.</i></p> | <p>So the king of Egypt called the midwives and said to them, 'Why have you done this, and let the male children live?'</p> <p>The midwives said to Pharaoh, 'Because the Hebrew women are not like the Egyptian women; they are vigorous and give birth before the midwife comes to them.'</p> <p>So God dealt well with the midwives, and the people multiplied and grew very strong.</p> <p>because the midwives feared God, He gave them households of their own.</p> <p>Then Pharaoh commanded all his people, 'Every son that is born to the Hebrews you shall cast into the Nile, but every daughter you shall let live.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 2:1-2; Gen 46:8-26
v5 — Deut 10:22
v7 — Gen 46:3; Gen 1:28; Deut 26:5; Gen 35:11; Gen 9:1
v8 — Acts 7:18; Eccl 2:18-19
v10 — Acts 7:19; Ps 83:3-4; Prov 1:11
v11 — Gen 15:13; Gen 47:11; Ex 2:11; Ex 3:7
v12 — Ps 105:24; Ex 1:9
v14 — Acts 7:19; Num 20:15; Ex 2:23; Ex 6:9
v17 — Acts 5:29; Ex 1:21; Luke 12:5; Matt 10:28; Eccl 12:13
v20 — Eccl 8:12; Isa 3:10; Prov 11:18
v21 — 1 Kgs 11:38; 1 Sam 2:35; Ps 37:3; Eccl 8:12; 2 Sam 7:27-29
v22 — Acts 7:19

Chapter 2

A Levite woman hid her infant son three months, then placed him in a basket among the reeds of the Nile; Pharaoh's daughter found the child, named him Moses, and raised him in the palace. As an adult Moses killed an Egyptian who was beating a Hebrew, and when the deed became known he fled to Midian, where he married Zipporah the daughter of Reuel. Meanwhile God heard the groaning of Israel in their bondage and remembered his covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

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| 1 | <i>And there went a man of the house of Levi, and took to wife a daughter of Levi.</i> | Now a man of the house of Levi went and took as his wife a daughter of Levi. |
| 2 | <i>And the woman conceived, and bare a son: and when she saw him that he was a goodly child, she hid him three months.</i> | The woman conceived and bore a son, and when she saw that he was a beautiful child, she hid him three months. |
| 3 | <i>And when she could not longer hide him, she took for him an ark of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and with pitch, and put the child therein; and she laid it in the flags by the river's brink.</i> | When she could hide him no longer, she took for him a basket made of bulrushes and daubed it with bitumen and pitch. She put the child in it and placed it among the reeds by the river bank. |
| 4 | <i>And his sister stood afar off, to wit what would be done to him.</i> | his sister stood at a distance to know what would be done to him. |

- 5 *And the daughter of Pharaoh came down to wash herself at the river; and her maidens walked along by the river's side; and when she saw the ark among the flags, she sent her maid to fetch it.* Now the daughter of Pharaoh came down to bathe at the river, while her attendants walked beside the river. She saw the basket among the reeds and sent her servant woman to fetch it.
- 6 *And when she had opened it, she saw the child: and, behold, the babe wept. And she had compassion on him, and said, This is one of the Hebrews' children.* When she opened it, she saw the child, and the baby was crying. She took pity on him and said, 'This is one of the Hebrews' children.'
- 7 *Then said his sister to Pharaoh's daughter, Shall I go and call to thee a nurse of the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for thee?* Then his sister said to Pharaoh's daughter, 'Shall I go and call you a nurse from the Hebrew women to nurse the child for you?'
- 8 *And Pharaoh's daughter said to her, Go. And the maid went and called the child's mother.* Pharaoh's daughter said to her, 'Go.' So the girl went and called the child's mother.
- 9 *And Pharaoh's daughter said unto her, Take this child away, and nurse it for me, and I will give thee thy wages. And the women took the child, and nursed it.* Pharaoh's daughter said to her, 'Take this child away and nurse him for me. I will give you your wages.' So the woman took the child and nursed him.
- **NAME NOTE** *Moses (MO-zez) — "Drawn out" The deliverer of Israel. Saved from Pharaoh's death decree by his mother, adopted by Pharaoh's daughter, raised in the palace, fled to Midian, called at the burning bush. Led Israel out of Egypt, received the Law at Sinai. Died at 120.*
- 10 *And the child grew, and she brought him unto Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. And she called his name Moses: and she said, Because I drew him out of the water.* When the child grew up, she brought him to Pharaoh's daughter. He became her son. She named him Moses, saying, 'Because I drew him out of the water.'

- 11 *And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren.* One day, after Moses had grown up, he went out to his brothers and looked on their burdens. He saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew, one of his brothers.
- 12 *And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.* He looked this way and that, and seeing no one, he killed the Egyptian and hid him in the sand.
- 13 *And when he went out the second day, behold, two men of the Hebrews strove together: and he said to him that did the wrong, Wherefore smitest thou thy fellow?* The next day he went out and saw two Hebrews fighting. He said to the man in the wrong, 'Why do you strike your companion?'
- 14 *And he said, Who made thee a prince and a judge over us? intendest thou to kill me, as thou killedst the Egyptian? And Moses feared, and said, Surely this thing is known.* The man said, 'Who made you a prince and a judge over us? Do you mean to kill me as you killed the Egyptian?' Then Moses was afraid and said, 'Surely the thing is known.'
- 15 *Now when Pharaoh heard this thing, he sought to slay Moses. But Moses fled from the face of Pharaoh, and dwelt in the land of Midian: and he sat down by a well.* When Pharaoh heard of it, he sought to kill Moses. But Moses fled from Pharaoh and settled in the land of Midian. He sat down by a well.
- 16 *Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters: and they came and drew water, and filled the troughs to water their father's flock.* Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters. They came and drew water and filled the troughs to water their father's flock.
- 17 *And the shepherds came and drove them away: but Moses stood up and helped them, and watered their flock.* The shepherds came and drove them away, but Moses stood up and saved them, and watered their flock.

■ **NAME NOTE** Reuel (ROO-el) — "Friend of God" Priest of Midian; Moses's father-in-law. Also called Jethro. Father of Zipporah.

- 18 *And when they came to Reuel their father, he said, How is it that ye are come so soon to day?* When they came home to their father Reuel, he said, 'How is it that you have come so soon today?'
- 19 *And they said, An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds, and also drew water enough for us, and watered the flock.* They said, 'An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds and even drew water for us and watered the flock.'
- 20 *And he said unto his daughters, And where is he? why is it that ye have left the man? call him, that he may eat bread.* He said to his daughters, 'Then where is he? Why have you left the man? Call him, that he may eat bread.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Zipporah (ZIP-or-ah) — "Bird, sparrow" Moses's wife, daughter of the priest of Midian. Bore him two sons: Gershom and Eliezer.

- 21 *And Moses was content to dwell with the man: and he gave Moses Zipporah his daughter.* Moses was content to dwell with the man. He gave Moses his daughter Zipporah.

■ **NAME NOTE** Gershom (GUR-shom) — "Stranger there, sojourner" Moses's firstborn son, named for his exile in Midian. (Different from Gershon, Levi's son.)

- 22 *And she bare him a son, and he called his name Gershom: for he said, I have been a stranger in a strange land.* She gave birth to a son. He called his name Gershom, for he said, 'I have been a sojourner in a foreign land.'
- 23 *And it came to pass in process of time, that the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel sighed by reason of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up unto God by reason of the bondage.* During those many days the king of Egypt died, and the children of Israel groaned because of their slavery and cried out for help. Their cry for rescue from slavery came up to God.
- 24 *And God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.* God heard their groaning. God remembered His covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.
- 25 *And God looked upon the children of Israel, and God had respect unto them.* God saw the children of Israel. God knew.

Words in this chapter:

- sojourner** — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.
- wit** — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'
- Isaac** (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.
- Levi** (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Num 26:59; Ex 6:16-20; 1 Chr 23:12-14
- v2** — Heb 11:23; Acts 7:20
- v3** — Ex 1:22; Gen 6:14; Acts 7:19; Isa 18:2; Matt 2:16
- v4** — Num 26:59; Ex 15:20; Mic 6:4
- v5** — Acts 7:21; Ps 9:9; Ps 12:5; Ex 8:20; Ps 46:1
- v10** — Heb 11:24; Acts 7:21-22; Gen 16:11; 1 Sam 1:20; Matt 1:21
- v14** — Luke 12:14; Matt 21:23; Gen 37:19-20; Luke 19:14; Gen 19:9
- v15** — Acts 7:29; Heb 11:27; Gen 24:11; Gen 29:2; John 4:6
- v16** — Gen 24:11; Ex 3:1; 1 Sam 9:11; Gen 24:14-20; Gen 29:6-10
- v23** — Gen 18:20-21; Jas 5:4; Ex 3:7-9; Acts 7:30; Deut 26:6-7
- v24** — Gen 26:3; Ps 105:42; Ex 6:5; Gen 15:14-18; Ps 22:24
- v25** — Ex 4:31; Ps 55:22; Ex 3:7-8; Ps 1:6; Luke 1:25

Chapter 3

While tending Jethro's flock near Horeb, Moses saw a bush burning with fire that was not consumed; God spoke from the bush, revealing himself as the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and commissioned Moses to deliver Israel from Egypt. When Moses asked God's name, God answered "I AM THAT I AM" and promised to bring the people out to a land flowing with milk and honey, warning that Pharaoh would not let them go except by a mighty hand.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jethro (*JETH-ro*) — "Excellence, preeminence" Moses's father-in-law, priest of Midian (same man as Reuel). Later gave Moses wise counsel on delegating judicial authority (Exodus 18). Horeb (*HOR-eb*) — "Desert, desolate" The mountain of God; another name for Mount Sinai where Moses saw the burning bush and later received the Law.

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Now Moses kept the flock of Jethro his father in law, the priest of Midian: and he led the flock to the backside of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, even to Horeb.
- Now Moses was keeping the flock of his father-in-law Jethro, the priest of Midian. He led his flock to the far side of the wilderness and came to Horeb, the mountain of God.

- 2 *And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he looked, and, behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed.* the angel of the LORD appeared to Him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush. He looked, and the bush was burning, yet it was not consumed.
- 3 *And Moses said, I will now turn aside, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt.* Moses said, 'I will turn aside to see this great sight, why the bush is not burned.'
- 4 *And when the LORD saw that he turned aside to see, God called unto him out of the midst of the bush, and said, Moses, Moses. And he said, Here am I.* When the LORD saw that He turned aside to see, God called to Him out of the bush, 'Moses, Moses!' And he said, 'Here I am.'
- 5 *And he said, Draw not nigh hither: put off thy shoes from off thy feet, for the place whereon thou standest is holy ground.* Then He said, 'Do not come near; take Your sandals off Your feet, for the place on which You are standing is holy ground.'
- 6 *Moreover he said, I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. And Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look upon God.* he said, 'I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.' And Moses hid his face, for he was afraid to look at God.
- 7 *And the LORD said, I have surely seen the affliction of my people which are in Egypt, and have heard their cry by reason of their taskmasters; for I know their sorrows;* Then the LORD said, 'I have surely seen the affliction of my people who are in Egypt and have heard their cry because of their taskmasters. I know their sorrows,

- 8 *And I am come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land unto a good land and a large, unto a land flowing with milk and honey; unto the place of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites.* I have come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians and to bring them up out of that land to a good and broad land, a land flowing with milk and honey, to the place of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites.
- 9 *Now therefore, behold, the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have also seen the oppression wherewith the Egyptians oppress them.* now, the cry of the children of Israel has come to me. I have also seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them.
- 10 *Come now therefore, and I will send thee unto Pharaoh, that thou mayest bring forth my people the children of Israel out of Egypt.* Come, I will send you to Pharaoh that you may bring my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt.'
- 11 *And Moses said unto God, Who am I, that I should go unto Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt?* But Moses said to God, 'Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the children of Israel out of Egypt?'
- 12 *And he said, Certainly I will be with thee; and this shall be a token unto thee, that I have sent thee: When thou hast brought forth the people out of Egypt, ye shall serve God upon this mountain.* He said, 'I will be with you, and this shall be the sign for you, that I have sent you: when you have brought the people out of Egypt, you shall serve God on this mountain.'
- 13 *And Moses said unto God, Behold, when I come unto the children of Israel, and shall say unto them, The God of your fathers hath sent me unto you; and they shall say to me, What is his name? what shall I say unto them?* Then Moses said to God, 'If I come to the children of Israel and say to them, The God of your fathers has sent me to you. They ask me, What is His name? what shall I say to them?'

- 14 *And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM: and he said, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you.* God said to Moses, 'I AM THAT I AM.' And he said, 'Say this to the children of Israel: I AM has sent me to you.'
- 15 *And God said moreover unto Moses, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, The LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath sent me unto you: this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations.* God also said to Moses, 'Say this to the children of Israel: The LORD, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you. This is my name forever, and thus I am to be remembered throughout all generations.'
- 16 *Go, and gather the elders of Israel together, and say unto them, The LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, appeared unto me, saying, I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt:* Go and gather the elders of Israel together and say to them, The LORD, the God of Your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, has appeared to me, saying, I have observed You and what has been done to You in Egypt,
- 17 *And I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt unto the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, unto a land flowing with milk and honey.* I promise that I will bring You up out of the affliction of Egypt to the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 18 *And they shall hearken to thy voice: and thou shalt come, thou and the elders of Israel, unto the king of Egypt, and ye shall say unto him, The LORD God of the Hebrews hath met with us: and now let us go, we beseech thee, three days' journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.* they will listen to Your voice, and You and the elders of Israel shall go to the king of Egypt and say to him, The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. And now, please let us go a three days' journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.

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| 19 | <i>And I am sure that the king of Egypt will not let you go, no, not by a mighty hand.</i> | But I know that the king of Egypt will not let you go unless compelled by a mighty hand. |
| 20 | <i>And I will stretch out my hand, and smite Egypt with all my wonders which I will do in the midst thereof: and after that he will let you go.</i> | So I will stretch out my hand and strike Egypt with all the wonders that I will do in it; after that he will let you go. |
| 21 | <i>And I will give this people favour in the sight of the Egyptians: and it shall come to pass, that, when ye go, ye shall not go empty:</i> | I will give this people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, so that when you go, you shall not go empty. |
| 22 | <i>But every woman shall borrow of her neighbour, and of her that sojourneth in her house, jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment: and ye shall put them upon your sons, and upon your daughters; and ye shall spoil the Egyptians.</i> | Each woman shall ask of her neighbor, and any woman who lives in her house, for silver and gold jewelry, and for clothing. You shall put them on your sons and on your daughters. So you shall plunder the Egyptians.' |

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Acts 7:30-35; Isa 43:2; Mark 12:26; Deut 33:16; Ps 66:12
v5 — Josh 5:15; Acts 7:33; Ex 19:12; Eccl 5:1; Gen 28:16-17
v6 — Luke 20:37; Matt 22:32; Ex 4:5; Gen 28:13; Mark 12:26
v7 — Ps 145:19; Ps 106:44; Ex 2:23-25; Ps 34:6; Ex 22:23
v8 — Gen 50:24; Ex 3:17; Gen 15:18-21; Ex 13:5; Deut 1:25
v9 — Prov 22:22-23; Ex 2:23; Ex 1:11; Ex 3:7; Ex 1:13-14
v10 — Mic 6:4; 1 Sam 12:6; Isa 63:11-12; Ps 105:26; Acts 7:34
v11 — 1 Sam 18:18; Ex 6:12; 2 Cor 3:5; Jer 1:6; 2 Cor 2:16
v12 — Josh 1:5; Rom 8:31; Isa 41:10; Deut 31:23; Ex 4:15
v14 — John 8:58; Heb 13:8; Rev 1:8; Ps 90:2; Isa 44:6
v15 — Gen 17:7-8; Heb 13:8; Mal 3:6; Hos 12:5; Ex 3:6
v21 — Ex 12:36; Ps 105:37; Ex 11:3; Prov 16:7; Ps 106:46

Chapter 4

God gave Moses three signs to prove his authority — the staff turned serpent, the leprous hand, and water turned to blood — and when Moses protested that he was slow of speech, the LORD angrily appointed Aaron as his spokesman. Moses returned to Egypt with his family; on the way the LORD sought to kill him until Zipporah circumcised their son. Aaron met Moses at the mountain of God, and together they gathered Israel's elders, performed the signs, and the people believed and worshiped.

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| <p>1 <i>And Moses answered and said, But, behold, they will not believe me, nor hearken unto my voice: for they will say, The LORD hath not appeared unto thee.</i></p> | <p>Then Moses answered, 'But they will not believe me or listen to my voice, for they will say, The LORD did not appear to You.'</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the LORD said unto him, What is that in thine hand? And he said, A rod.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Him, 'What is that in Your hand?' He said, 'A staff.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he said, Cast it on the ground. And he cast it on the ground, and it became a serpent; and Moses fled from before it.</i></p> | <p>he said, 'Throw it on the ground.' So he threw it on the ground. It became a serpent, and Moses ran from it.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Put forth thine hand, and take it by the tail. And he put forth his hand, and caught it, and it became a rod in his hand:</i></p> | <p>But the LORD said to Moses, 'Put out your hand and catch it by the tail.' So he put out his hand and caught it. It became a staff in his hand,</p> |

- 5 *That they may believe that the LORD God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared unto thee.* 'that they may believe that the LORD, the God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has appeared to you.'
- 6 *And the LORD said furthermore unto him, Put now thine hand into thy bosom. And he put his hand into his bosom: and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous as snow.* The LORD said to Him again, 'Put Your hand inside Your cloak.' And He put His hand inside His cloak, and when He took it out, His hand was leprous like snow.
- 7 *And he said, Put thine hand into thy bosom again. And he put his hand into his bosom again; and plucked it out of his bosom, and, behold, it was turned again as his other flesh.* Then God said, 'Put Your hand back inside Your cloak.' So He put His hand back inside His cloak, and when He took it out, it was restored like the rest of His flesh.
- 8 *And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe thee, neither hearken to the voice of the first sign, that they will believe the voice of the latter sign.* 'If they will not believe You or listen to the first sign, they may believe the latter sign.'
- 9 *And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe also these two signs, neither hearken unto thy voice, that thou shalt take of the water of the river, and pour it upon the dry land: and the water which thou takest out of the river shall become blood upon the dry land.* If they will not believe even these two signs or listen to Your voice, You shall take some water from the Nile and pour it on the dry ground, and the water that You shall take from the Nile will become blood on the dry ground.'
- 10 *And Moses said unto the LORD, O my Lord, I am not eloquent, neither heretofore, nor since thou hast spoken unto thy servant: but I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.* But Moses said to the LORD, 'Oh, my Lord, I am not eloquent, either in the past or since You have spoken to Your servant. But I am slow of speech and of tongue.'

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| <p>11 <i>And the LORD said unto him, Who hath made man's mouth? or who maketh the dumb, or deaf, or the seeing, or the blind? have not I the LORD?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Now therefore go, and I will be with thy mouth, and teach thee what thou shalt say.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And he said, O my Lord, send, I pray thee, by the hand of him whom thou wilt send.</i></p> | <p>Then the LORD said to Him, 'Who has made man's mouth? Who makes Him mute, or deaf, or seeing, or blind? Is it not I, the LORD?</p> <p>Now therefore go. I will be with Your mouth and teach You what You shall speak.'</p> <p>But He said, 'Oh, my Lord, please send someone else.'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Aaron (AIR-un) — "Lofty, exalted" Moses's older brother, a Levite. Became Israel's first high priest. Spokesman for Moses before Pharaoh.

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| <p>14 <i>And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Moses, and he said, Is not Aaron the Levite thy brother? I know that he can speak well. And also, behold, he cometh forth to meet thee: and when he seeth thee, he will be glad in his heart.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And thou shalt speak unto him, and put words in his mouth: and I will be with thy mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what ye shall do.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And he shall be thy spokesman unto the people: and he shall be, even he shall be to thee instead of a mouth, and thou shalt be to him instead of God.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And thou shalt take this rod in thine hand, wherewith thou shalt do signs.</i></p> | <p>Then the anger of the LORD was kindled against Moses and he said, 'Is there not Aaron your brother, the Levite? I know that he can speak well. He is coming out to meet You, and when He sees You, He will be glad in His heart.</p> <p>You shall speak to Him and put the words in His mouth. I will be with Your mouth and with His mouth and will teach You both what You shall do.</p> <p>He shall speak for You to the people. He shall be your mouth, and you shall be as God to Him.</p> <p>take in Your hand this staff, with which You shall do the signs.'</p> |
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- 18 *And Moses went and returned to Jethro his father in law, and said unto him, Let me go, I pray thee, and return unto my brethren which are in Egypt, and see whether they be yet alive. And Jethro said to Moses, Go in peace.* Moses went back to Jethro his father-in-law and said to him, 'Please let me go back to my brothers in Egypt to see whether they are still alive.' And Jethro said to Moses, 'Go in peace.'
- 19 *And the LORD said unto Moses in Midian, Go, return into Egypt: for all the men are dead which sought thy life.* the LORD said to Moses in Midian, 'Go back to Egypt, for all the men who were seeking your life are dead.'
- 20 *And Moses took his wife and his sons, and set them upon an ass, and he returned to the land of Egypt: and Moses took the rod of God in his hand.* So Moses took his wife and his sons and had them ride on a donkey, and went back to the land of Egypt. And Moses took the staff of God in His hand.
- 21 *And the LORD said unto Moses, When thou goest to return into Egypt, see that thou do all those wonders before Pharaoh, which I have put in thine hand: but I will harden his heart, that he shall not let the people go.* the LORD said to Moses, 'When you go back to Egypt, see that you do before Pharaoh all the miracles that I have put in your power. But I will harden his heart, so that he will not let the people go.'
- 22 *And thou shalt say unto Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD, Israel is my son, even my firstborn:* Then You shall say to Pharaoh, Thus says the LORD, Israel is my firstborn son,
- 23 *And I say unto thee, Let my son go, that he may serve me: and if thou refuse to let him go, behold, I will slay thy son, even thy firstborn.* I say to You, Let my son go that He may serve me. If You refuse to let Him go, I will kill Your firstborn son.'
- 24 *And it came to pass by the way in the inn, that the LORD met him, and sought to kill him.* At a lodging place on the way the LORD met Him and sought to put Him to death.

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| <p>25 <i>Then Zipporah took a sharp stone, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet, and said, Surely a bloody husband art thou to me.</i></p> <p>26 <i>So he let him go: then she said, A bloody husband thou art, because of the circumcision.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And the LORD said to Aaron, Go into the wilderness to meet Moses. And he went, and met him in the mount of God, and kissed him.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And Moses told Aaron all the words of the LORD who had sent him, and all the signs which he had commanded him.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel:</i></p> <p>30 <i>And Aaron spake all the words which the LORD had spoken unto Moses, and did the signs in the sight of the people.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And the people believed: and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel, and that he had looked upon their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshipped.</i></p> | <p>Then Zipporah took a flint and cut off her son's foreskin and cast it at His feet and said, 'Surely a bloody husband You are to me!'</p> <p>So He let Him alone. Then she said, 'A bloody husband,' because of the circumcision.</p> <p>The LORD said to Aaron, 'Go into the wilderness to meet Moses.' So he went and met him at the mountain of God and kissed Him.</p> <p>Moses told Aaron all the words of the LORD Who had sent Him, and all the signs that He had commanded Him.</p> <p>Then Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel.</p> <p>Aaron spoke all the words that the LORD had spoken to Moses and did the signs in the sight of the people.</p> <p>the people believed, and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel and that He had seen their affliction, they bowed their heads and worshiped.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 4:17; Ex 4:20; Isa 11:4; Ps 110:2

v6 — Num 12:10; 2 Kgs 5:27

v10 — Jer 1:6; Ex 6:12; Acts 7:22; Ex 4:1; 2 Cor 11:6

- v11** — Ezek 3:26-27; Amos 3:6; Ps 146:8; Ps 94:9; Isa 6:7
v12 — Jer 1:9; Luke 12:11-12; Matt 10:19-20; Luke 21:14-15; Mark 13:11
v15 — Isa 51:16; Deut 18:18; Luke 21:15; Num 23:12; Num 23:5
v19 — Matt 2:20; Ex 2:23; Ex 2:15
v21 — Rom 9:18; Ex 14:8; Isa 63:17; Josh 11:20; Ex 9:12
v22 — Hos 11:1; Rom 9:4; Heb 12:23; Jer 31:9; Deut 14:1
v23 — Ex 11:5; Ex 12:29
v24 — Gen 17:14; Num 22:22-23
v31 — Ex 3:18; Ex 2:25; Ex 12:27; Ps 106:12-13

Chapter 5

Moses and Aaron told Pharaoh to let Israel go, but Pharaoh refused and instead increased the people's burden, requiring them to gather their own straw while maintaining the same quota of bricks. The Israelite foremen were beaten when they could not meet the demand, and they blamed Moses and Aaron for making things worse. Moses cried out to the LORD, asking why he had brought more evil upon the people instead of delivering them.

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| <p>¹ <i>And afterward Moses and Aaron went in, and told Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Let my people go, that they may hold a feast unto me in the wilderness.</i></p> | <p>Afterward Moses and Aaron went and said to Pharaoh, 'Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, Let my people go, that they may hold a feast to me in the wilderness.'</p> |
| <p>² <i>And Pharaoh said, Who is the LORD, that I should obey his voice to let Israel go? I know not the LORD, neither will I let Israel go.</i></p> | <p>But Pharaoh said, 'Who is the LORD, that I should obey His voice and let Israel go? I do not know the LORD, and moreover, I will not let Israel go.'</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And they said, The God of the Hebrews hath met with us: let us go, we pray thee, three days' journey into the desert, and sacrifice unto the LORD our God; lest he fall upon us with pestilence, or with the sword.</i></p> | <p>Then they said, 'The God of the Hebrews has met with us. Please let us go a three days' journey into the wilderness that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God, lest He fall upon us with pestilence or with the sword.'</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>And the king of Egypt said unto them, Wherefore do ye, Moses and Aaron, let the people from their works? get you unto your burdens.</i></p> | <p>But the king of Egypt said to them, 'Moses and Aaron, why do you take the people away from their work? Get back to your burdens.'</p> |

- 5 *And Pharaoh said, Behold, the people of the land now are many, and ye make them rest from their burdens.* Pharaoh said, ' the people of the land are now many, and you make them rest from their burdens.'
- 6 *And Pharaoh commanded the same day the taskmasters of the people, and their officers, saying,* The same day Pharaoh commanded the taskmasters of the people and their foremen,
- 7 *Ye shall no more give the people straw to make brick, as heretofore: let them go and gather straw for themselves.* 'You shall no longer give the people straw to make bricks, as before. Let them go and gather straw for themselves.
- 8 *And the tale of the bricks, which they did make heretofore, ye shall lay upon them; ye shall not diminish ought thereof: for they be idle; therefore they cry, saying, Let us go and sacrifice to our God.* But the number of bricks that they made in the past you shall impose on them; you shall not reduce it, for they are idle. That is why they cry, Let us go and offer sacrifice to our God.
- 9 *Let there more work be laid upon the men, that they may labour therein; and let them not regard vain words.* Let heavier work be laid on the men, that they may labor at it and pay no regard to lying words.'
- 10 *And the taskmasters of the people went out, and their officers, and they spake to the people, saying, Thus saith Pharaoh, I will not give you straw.* So the taskmasters and the foremen of the people went out and said to the people, 'Thus says Pharaoh, I will not give you straw.
- 11 *Go ye, get you straw where ye can find it: yet not ought of your work shall be diminished.* Go and get your straw yourselves wherever you can find it, but your work will not be reduced in the least.'
- 12 *So the people were scattered abroad throughout all the land of Egypt to gather stubble instead of straw.* So the people were scattered throughout all the land of Egypt to gather stubble for straw.
- 13 *And the taskmasters hasted them, saying, Fulfil your works, your daily tasks, as when there was straw.* The taskmasters were urgent, saying, 'Complete your work, your daily task each day, as when there was straw.'

- 14 *And the officers of the children of Israel, which Pharaoh's taskmasters had set over them, were beaten, and demanded, Wherefore have ye not fulfilled your task in making brick both yesterday and to day, as heretofore?* the foremen of the children of Israel, whom Pharaoh's taskmasters had set over them, were beaten and were asked, 'Why have you not done all your work of making bricks today and yesterday, as in the past?'
- 15 *Then the officers of the children of Israel came and cried unto Pharaoh, saying, Wherefore dealest thou thus with thy servants?* Then the foremen of the children of Israel came and cried to Pharaoh, 'Why do you treat your servants like this?'
- 16 *There is no straw given unto thy servants, and they say to us, Make brick: and, behold, thy servants are beaten; but the fault is in thine own people.* No straw is given to your servants, yet they say to us, Make bricks! And your servants are beaten, but the fault is in your own people.'
- 17 *But he said, Ye are idle, ye are idle: therefore ye say, Let us go and do sacrifice to the LORD.* But He said, 'You are idle, You are idle; that is why You say, Let us go and sacrifice to the LORD.'
- 18 *Go therefore now, and work; for there shall no straw be given you, yet shall ye deliver the tale of bricks.* Go now and work. No straw will be given You, but You must still deliver the same number of bricks.'
- 19 *And the officers of the children of Israel did see that they were in evil case, after it was said, Ye shall not minish ought from your bricks of your daily task.* The foremen of the children of Israel saw that they were in trouble when they said, 'You shall by no means reduce Your number of bricks, Your daily task each day.'
- 20 *And they met Moses and Aaron, who stood in the way, as they came forth from Pharaoh:* They met Moses and Aaron, who were waiting for them, as they came out from Pharaoh.

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| <p>21 <i>And they said unto them, The LORD look upon you, and judge; because ye have made our savour to be abhorred in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of his servants, to put a sword in their hand to slay us.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, Lord, wherefore hast thou so evil entreated this people? why is it that thou hast sent me?</i></p> <p>23 <i>For since I came to Pharaoh to speak in thy name, he hath done evil to this people; neither hast thou delivered thy people at all.</i></p> | <p>they said to them, 'The LORD look on You and judge, because You have made us stink in the sight of Pharaoh and his servants, and have put a sword in their hand to kill us.'</p> <p>Then Moses turned to the LORD and said, 'O Lord, why have You done evil to this people? Why did You ever send me?'</p> <p>For since I came to Pharaoh to speak in your name, he has done evil to this people, and you have not delivered your people at all.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 10:9; Acts 4:29
v2 — Ex 3:19; Job 21:15; 2 Kgs 18:35
v3 — Ex 3:18
v4 — Ex 1:11

Chapter 6

The LORD reassured Moses, revealing his name JEHOVAH and renewing his covenant promises to bring Israel out of Egypt with great judgments and give them the land sworn to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. The genealogy of Reuben, Simeon, and Levi is given, tracing the Levitical line through Kohath and Amram to Moses and Aaron, and through Aaron to his sons Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. The LORD commanded Moses and Aaron again to go to Pharaoh despite Moses' protest that he was of uncircumcised lips.

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| <p>1 <i>Then the LORD said unto Moses, Now shalt thou see what I will do to Pharaoh: for with a strong hand shall he let them go, and with a strong hand shall he drive them out of his land.</i></p> | <p>Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Now you shall see what I will do to Pharaoh, for with a strong hand he will send them out, and with a strong hand he will drive them out of his land.'</p> |
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- 2 *And God spake unto Moses, and said unto him, I am the LORD:* God spoke to Moses and said to him, 'I am the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Jehovah* (jeh-HO-vah) — "The self-existent One, I AM" The personal, covenant name of God — traditionally spelled YHWH in Hebrew. Rendered LORD (all caps) throughout most of the KJV; here spelled out explicitly as JEHOVAH.

- 3 *And I appeared unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, by the name of God Almighty, but by my name JEHOVAH was I not known to them.* I appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob as God Almighty, but by my name JEHOVAH was I not known to them.
- 4 *And I have also established my covenant with them, to give them the land of Canaan, the land of their pilgrimage, wherein they were strangers.* I also established my covenant with them to give them the land of Canaan, the land in which they lived as sojourners.
- 5 *And I have also heard the groaning of the children of Israel, whom the Egyptians keep in bondage; and I have remembered my covenant.* Moreover, I have heard the groaning of the children of Israel, whom the Egyptians hold as slaves. I have remembered my covenant.
- 6 *Wherefore say unto the children of Israel, I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I will rid you out of their bondage, and I will redeem you with a stretched out arm, and with great judgments:* Say therefore to the children of Israel, I am the LORD. I will bring You out from under the burdens of the Egyptians. I will deliver You from slavery to them. I will redeem You with an outstretched arm and with great acts of judgment.
- 7 *And I will take you to me for a people, and I will be to you a God: and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God, which bringeth you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians.* I will take You to be my people. I will be Your God, and You shall know that I am the LORD Your God, Who has brought You out from under the burdens of the Egyptians.
- 8 *And I will bring you in unto the land, concerning the which I did swear to give it to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob; and I will give it you for an heritage: I am the LORD.* I will bring You into the land that I swore to give to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob. I will give it to you for a possession. I am the LORD.'

- 9 *And Moses spake so unto the children of Israel: but they hearkened not unto Moses for anguish of spirit, and for cruel bondage.* Moses spoke thus to the children of Israel. But they did not listen to Moses, because of their broken spirit and harsh slavery.
- 10 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* So the LORD said to Moses,
- 11 *Go in, speak unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land.* 'Go in, tell Pharaoh king of Egypt to let the children of Israel go out of his land.'
- 12 *And Moses spake before the LORD, saying, Behold, the children of Israel have not hearkened unto me; how then shall Pharaoh hear me, who am of uncircumcised lips?* But Moses said to the LORD, 'the children of Israel have not listened to me. How then shall Pharaoh listen to me, for I am of uncircumcised lips?'
- 13 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, and gave them a charge unto the children of Israel, and unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt.* But the LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron and gave them a charge about the children of Israel and about Pharaoh king of Egypt: to bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt.
- 14 *These be the heads of their fathers' houses: The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel; Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi: these be the families of Reuben.* These are the heads of their fathers' houses: the sons of Reuben, the firstborn of Israel: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi; these are the clans of Reuben.
- 15 *And the sons of Simeon; Jemuel, and Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanitish woman: these are the families of Simeon.* The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul, the son of a Canaanite woman; these are the clans of Simeon.
- 16 *And these are the names of the sons of Levi according to their generations; Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari: and the years of the life of Levi were an hundred thirty and seven years.* These are the names of the sons of Levi according to their generations: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari, the years of the life of Levi being 137 years.

■ **NAME NOTE** Libni (LIB-nye) — "White" Son of Gershon. Founder of the Libnite clan of Levites. Shimi (SHIM-eye) — "Renowned, famous" Son of Gershon. Several Shimeis appear in Scripture; this one founded a Levitical clan.

- 17 *The sons of Gershon; Libni, and Shimi, according to their families.* The sons of Gershon: Libni and Shimei, by their clans.

■ **NAME NOTE** Amram (AM-ram) — "Exalted people" Son of Kohath, father of Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. Lived 137 years. Izhar (IZ-har) — "Fresh oil, shining" Son of Kohath, uncle of Moses and Aaron. Father of Korah. Uzziel (UZ-ee-el) — "My strength is God" Son of Kohath, uncle of Moses and Aaron.

- 18 *And the sons of Kohath; Amram, and Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel: and the years of the life of Kohath were an hundred thirty and three years.* The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel, the years of the life of Kohath being 133 years.
- 19 *And the sons of Merari; Mahali and Mushi: these are the families of Levi according to their generations.* The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the clans of the Levites according to their generations.

■ **NAME NOTE** Jochebed (JOCK-eh-bed) — "The LORD is glory" Mother of Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. Her courage in hiding baby Moses preserved the deliverer of Israel.

- 20 *And Amram took him Jochebed his father's sister to wife; and she bare him Aaron and Moses: and the years of the life of Amram were an hundred and thirty and seven years.* Amram took as his wife Jochebed his father's sister. She bore him Aaron and Moses, the years of the life of Amram being 137 years.

■ **NAME NOTE** Korah (KOR-ah) — "Bald, ice" Son of Izhar, a Kohathite Levite. Later led a rebellion against Moses and Aaron (Numbers 16) and was swallowed by the earth. His descendants became temple singers.

- 21 *And the sons of Izhar; Korah, and Nepheg, and Zichri.* The sons of Izhar: Korah, Nepheg, and Zichri.
- 22 *And the sons of Uzziel; Mishael, and Elzaphan, and Zithri.* The sons of Uzziel: Mishael, Elzaphan, and Sithri.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Elisheba (ee-LISH-eh-bah) — "God is my oath" Wife of Aaron, daughter of Amminadab, mother of the first four priests of Israel. The Greek form of her name is Elizabeth. Amminadab (uh-MIN-uh-dab) — "My kinsman is noble" Father of Elisheba (Aaron's wife) and of Nahshon. Ancestor of David and of Christ. Naashon (NAH-shon) — "Enchanter, serpent" Prince of the tribe of Judah during the wilderness years. Brother of Elisheba. Ancestor of David and of Christ. Nadab (NAY-dab) — "Generous, noble" Aaron's firstborn son. Later struck dead with his brother Abihu for offering "strange fire" before the LORD (Leviticus 10). Abihu (uh-BY-hoo) — "He is my father" Aaron's second son. Killed with Nadab for offering strange fire. Eleazar (EL-ee-AY-zar) — "God has helped" Aaron's third son. Succeeded his father as high priest after Aaron's death. Ithamar (ITH-uh-mar) — "Land of palm trees" Aaron's fourth son. Supervised the Levites in tabernacle service. Ancestor of the priestly line of Eli.*

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| <p>23 <i>And Aaron took him Elisheba, daughter of Amminadab, sister of Naashon, to wife; and she bare him Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.</i></p> | <p>Aaron took as his wife Elisheba, the daughter of Amminadab and the sister of Nahshon. She bore him Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>And the sons of Korah; Assir, and Elkanah, and Abiasaph: these are the families of the Korhites.</i></p> | <p>The sons of Korah: Assir, Elkanah, and Abiasaph; these are the clans of the Korahites.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Phinehas (FIN-ee-us) — "Serpent's mouth, or dark of skin" Grandson of Aaron. Famous for his zeal in Numbers 25, where he stopped a plague by killing an Israelite man and a Midianite woman. Received the covenant of a perpetual priesthood.*

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| <p>25 <i>And Eleazar Aaron's son took him one of the daughters of Putiel to wife; and she bare him Phinehas: these are the heads of the fathers of the Levites according to their families.</i></p> | <p>Eleazar, Aaron's son, took as his wife one of the daughters of Putiel. She bore him Phinehas. These are the heads of the fathers' houses of the Levites by their clans.</p> |
| <p>26 <i>These are that Aaron and Moses, to whom the LORD said, Bring out the children of Israel from the land of Egypt according to their armies.</i></p> | <p>These are the Aaron and Moses to whom the LORD said, 'Bring out the children of Israel from the land of Egypt by their hosts.'</p> |
| <p>27 <i>These are they which spake to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring out the children of Israel from Egypt: these are that Moses and Aaron.</i></p> | <p>It was they who spoke to Pharaoh king of Egypt about bringing out the children of Israel from Egypt — this Moses and this Aaron.</p> |

- 28 *And it came to pass on the day when the LORD spake unto Moses in the land of Egypt,* On the day when the LORD spoke to Moses in the land of Egypt,
- 29 *That the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, I am the LORD: speak thou unto Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I say unto thee.* the LORD said to Moses, 'I am the LORD. Tell Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I say to you.'
- 30 *And Moses said before the LORD, Behold, I am of uncircumcised lips, and how shall Pharaoh hearken unto me?* But Moses said to the LORD, 'I am of uncircumcised lips. How will Pharaoh listen to me?'

Words in this chapter:

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 12:33; Ex 12:39; Ex 12:31; Ps 136:12; Ex 3:19-20

v3 — Ps 83:18; Ps 68:4; Gen 17:1; Ex 3:14; Gen 48:3

v4 — Gen 28:4; Gen 15:18; Gen 17:7-8

v5 — Ex 2:24; Ps 106:44-45

v6 — Deut 26:8; 1 Chr 17:21; Ex 7:4; Deut 7:8; Neh 1:10

v7 — Deut 29:13; Deut 7:6; Deut 4:20

v8 — Gen 15:18; Gen 26:3

v12 — Ex 4:10; Ex 6:30; Jer 1:6

v15 — Gen 46:10; 1 Chr 4:24

v19 — 1 Chr 6:19; Num 3:20; 1 Chr 23:21

v23 — Ruth 4:19-20; Num 2:3; Num 1:7; 1 Chr 6:3; 1 Chr 2:10

v26 — Ex 12:51; Ex 7:4; Ex 12:17; Ex 6:13

Chapter 7

The LORD made Moses as God to Pharaoh and Aaron his prophet, warning that he would harden Pharaoh's heart and multiply his signs in Egypt. Aaron's staff became a serpent before Pharaoh and swallowed the staffs of the Egyptian magicians, but Pharaoh's heart remained hard. The LORD sent the first plague: Aaron struck the Nile with his staff and all the water turned to blood, killing the fish and making the river stink for seven days.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, See, I have made thee a god to Pharaoh: and Aaron thy brother shall be thy prophet.</i></p> | <p>the LORD said to Moses, 'See, I have made you like God to Pharaoh, and your brother Aaron shall be your prophet.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thou shalt speak all that I command thee: and Aaron thy brother shall speak unto Pharaoh, that he send the children of Israel out of his land.</i></p> | <p>You shall speak all that I command you, and your brother Aaron shall tell Pharaoh to let the children of Israel go out of his land.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and multiply my signs and my wonders in the land of Egypt.</i></p> | <p>But I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and though I multiply my signs and wonders in the land of Egypt,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you, that I may lay my hand upon Egypt, and bring forth mine armies, and my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great judgments.</i></p> | <p>Pharaoh will not listen to you. Then I will lay my hand on Egypt and bring my hosts, my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great acts of judgment.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I stretch forth mine hand upon Egypt, and bring out the children of Israel from among them.</i></p> | <p>The Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I stretch out my hand against Egypt and bring out the children of Israel from among them.'</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And Moses and Aaron did as the LORD commanded them, so did they.</i></p> | <p>Moses and Aaron did so; they did just as the LORD commanded them.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And Moses was fourscore years old, and Aaron fourscore and three years old, when they spake unto Pharaoh.</i></p> | <p>Now Moses was 80 years old, and Aaron 83 years old, when they spoke to Pharaoh.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,</i></p> | <p>Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron,</p> |

- 9 *When Pharaoh shall speak unto you, saying, Shew a miracle for you: then thou shalt say unto Aaron, Take thy rod, and cast it before Pharaoh, and it shall become a serpent.* 'When Pharaoh says to you, Prove yourselves by working a miracle, then you shall say to Aaron, Take your staff and cast it down before Pharaoh, that it may become a serpent.'
- 10 *And Moses and Aaron went in unto Pharaoh, and they did so as the LORD had commanded: and Aaron cast down his rod before Pharaoh, and before his servants, and it became a serpent.* So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and did just as the LORD commanded. Aaron cast down his staff before Pharaoh and his servants. It became a serpent.
- 11 *Then Pharaoh also called the wise men and the sorcerers: now the magicians of Egypt, they also did in like manner with their enchantments.* Then Pharaoh summoned the wise men and the sorcerers. They, the magicians of Egypt, also did the same by their secret arts.
- 12 *For they cast down every man his rod, and they became serpents: but Aaron's rod swallowed up their rods.* For each man cast down his staff. They became serpents. But Aaron's staff swallowed up their staffs.
- 13 *And he hardened Pharaoh's heart, that he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.* Still Pharaoh's heart was hardened. He would not listen to them, as the LORD had said.
- 14 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh's heart is hardened, he refuseth to let the people go.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Pharaoh's heart is hardened; he refuses to let the people go.
- 15 *Get thee unto Pharaoh in the morning; lo, he goeth out unto the water; and thou shalt stand by the river's brink against he come; and the rod which was turned to a serpent shalt thou take in thine hand.* Go to Pharaoh in the morning, as he is going out to the water. Stand on the bank of the Nile to meet him, and take in your hand the staff that turned into a serpent.

- 16 *And thou shalt say unto him, The LORD God of the Hebrews hath sent me unto thee, saying, Let my people go, that they may serve me in the wilderness: and, behold, hitherto thou wouldest not hear.* you shall say to Him, The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, sent me to You, saying, Let my people go, that they may serve me in the wilderness. But so far, You have not obeyed.
- 17 *Thus saith the LORD, In this thou shalt know that I am the LORD: behold, I will smite with the rod that is in mine hand upon the waters which are in the river, and they shall be turned to blood.* Thus says the LORD, By this You shall know that I am the LORD: with the staff that is in my hand I will strike the water that is in the Nile. It shall turn into blood.
- 18 *And the fish that is in the river shall die, and the river shall stink; and the Egyptians shall lothe to drink of the water of the river.* The fish in the Nile shall die, and the Nile will stink, and the Egyptians will grow weary of drinking water from the Nile.'
- 19 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, Take thy rod, and stretch out thine hand upon the waters of Egypt, upon their streams, upon their rivers, and upon their ponds, and upon all their pools of water, that they may become blood; and that there may be blood throughout all the land of Egypt, both in vessels of wood, and in vessels of stone.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Say to Aaron, Take your staff and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt, over their rivers, their canals, their ponds, and all their pools of water, so that they may become blood, and there shall be blood throughout all the land of Egypt, even in vessels of wood and in vessels of stone.'
- 20 *And Moses and Aaron did so, as the LORD commanded; and he lifted up the rod, and smote the waters that were in the river, in the sight of Pharaoh, and in the sight of his servants; and all the waters that were in the river were turned to blood.* Moses and Aaron did as the LORD commanded. In the sight of Pharaoh and in the sight of his servants he lifted up the staff and struck the water in the Nile. All the water in the Nile turned into blood.

- 21 *And the fish that was in the river died; and the river stank, and the Egyptians could not drink of the water of the river; and there was blood throughout all the land of Egypt.* the fish in the Nile died, and the Nile stank, so that the Egyptians could not drink water from the Nile. There was blood throughout all the land of Egypt.
- 22 *And the magicians of Egypt did so with their enchantments: and Pharaoh's heart was hardened, neither did he hearken unto them; as the LORD had said.* But the magicians of Egypt did the same by their secret arts. So Pharaoh's heart remained hardened. He would not listen to them, as the LORD had said.
- 23 *And Pharaoh turned and went into his house, neither did he set his heart to this also.* Pharaoh turned and went into his house. He did not take even this to heart.
- 24 *And all the Egyptians digged round about the river for water to drink; for they could not drink of the water of the river.* all the Egyptians dug along the Nile for water to drink, for they could not drink the water of the Nile.
- 25 *And seven days were fulfilled, after that the LORD had smitten the river.* Seven full days passed after the LORD had struck the Nile.

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ex 4:15-16; Ps 82:6; John 10:35-36; Jer 1:10; 1 Kgs 17:23
v3 — Ex 4:21; Ex 11:9
v5 — Ex 14:18; Ex 7:17; Ex 8:22; Ex 14:4; Ex 3:20
v6 — Ex 7:2
v7 — Deut 34:7; Acts 7:30; Deut 31:2; Acts 7:23
v9 — Ex 4:2; John 2:18; Isa 7:11
v11 — Ex 7:22; 2 Tim 3:8; Ex 8:7; Ex 8:18
v13 — Ex 4:21; Ex 8:15
v16 — Ex 3:18; Ex 9:1; Ex 9:13
v17 — Ex 4:9; Ex 5:2; Ex 7:5
v19 — Ex 14:21; Ex 8:5-6; Ex 10:21; Ex 14:26; Ex 8:16
v20 — Ps 105:29; Ps 78:44

Chapter 8

The LORD sent frogs that swarmed over all Egypt; Pharaoh begged Moses to remove them and promised to let Israel go, but hardened his heart once the frogs died. The LORD then sent lice from the dust of the ground, and the magicians could not replicate it, confessing "This is the finger of God." Next the LORD sent swarms of flies on all Egypt but protected Goshen; again Pharaoh promised to let Israel go, then hardened his heart when the flies were removed.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, Go unto Pharaoh, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.</i> | Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Go in to Pharaoh and say to him, Thus says the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me. |
| 2 <i>And if thou refuse to let them go, behold, I will smite all thy borders with frogs:</i> | But if You refuse to let them go, I will plague all Your country with frogs. |
| 3 <i>And the river shall bring forth frogs abundantly, which shall go up and come into thine house, and into thy bedchamber, and upon thy bed, and into the house of thy servants, and upon thy people, and into thine ovens, and into thy kneadingtroughs:</i> | The Nile shall swarm with frogs that shall come up into Your house and into Your bedroom and on Your bed and into the houses of Your servants and Your people, and into Your ovens and Your kneading bowls. |
| 4 <i>And the frogs shall come up both on thee, and upon thy people, and upon all thy servants.</i> | The frogs shall come up on You and on Your people and on all Your servants.' |
| 5 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, Stretch forth thine hand with thy rod over the streams, over the rivers, and over the ponds, and cause frogs to come up upon the land of Egypt.</i> | the LORD said to Moses, 'Say to Aaron, Stretch out your hand with your staff over the rivers, over the canals and over the pools, and make frogs come up on the land of Egypt!' |
| 6 <i>And Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt; and the frogs came up, and covered the land of Egypt.</i> | So Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt, and the frogs came up and covered the land of Egypt. |

- 7 *And the magicians did so with their enchantments, and brought up frogs upon the land of Egypt.* But the magicians did the same by their secret arts and made frogs come up on the land of Egypt.
- 8 *Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron, and said, Intreat the LORD, that he may take away the frogs from me, and from my people; and I will let the people go, that they may do sacrifice unto the LORD.* Then Pharaoh called Moses and Aaron and said, 'Plead with the LORD to take away the frogs from me and from my people. I will let the people go to sacrifice to the LORD.'
- 9 *And Moses said unto Pharaoh, Glory over me: when shall I intreat for thee, and for thy servants, and for thy people, to destroy the frogs from thee and thy houses, that they may remain in the river only?* Moses said to Pharaoh, 'Have the honor of telling me when I am to plead for you and your servants and your people, that the frogs be cut off from you and your houses and be left only in the Nile.'
- 10 *And he said, To morrow. And he said, Be it according to thy word: that thou mayest know that there is none like unto the LORD our God.* he said, 'Tomorrow.' Moses said, 'Be it as you say, so that you may know that there is no one like the LORD our God.'
- 11 *And the frogs shall depart from thee, and from thy houses, and from thy servants, and from thy people; they shall remain in the river only.* The frogs shall go away from You and Your houses and Your servants and Your people. They shall be left only in the Nile.'
- 12 *And Moses and Aaron went out from Pharaoh: and Moses cried unto the LORD because of the frogs which he had brought against Pharaoh.* So Moses and Aaron went out from Pharaoh, and Moses cried to the LORD about the frogs, as He had agreed with Pharaoh.
- 13 *And the LORD did according to the word of Moses; and the frogs died out of the houses, out of the villages, and out of the fields.* the LORD did according to the word of Moses. The frogs died out in the houses, the courtyards, and the fields.
- 14 *And they gathered them together upon heaps: and the land stank.* they gathered them together in heaps, and the land stank.

- 15 *But when Pharaoh saw that there was respite, he hardened his heart, and hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.* But when Pharaoh saw that there was a respite, he hardened his heart and would not listen to them, as the LORD had said.
- 16 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, Stretch out thy rod, and smite the dust of the land, that it may become lice throughout all the land of Egypt.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Say to Aaron, Stretch out your staff and strike the dust of the earth, so that it may become gnats in all the land of Egypt.'
- 17 *And they did so; for Aaron stretched out his hand with his rod, and smote the dust of the earth, and it became lice in man, and in beast; all the dust of the land became lice throughout all the land of Egypt.* they did so. Aaron stretched out his hand with his staff and struck the dust of the earth, and there were gnats on man and beast. All the dust of the earth became gnats in all the land of Egypt.
- 18 *And the magicians did so with their enchantments to bring forth lice, but they could not: so there were lice upon man, and upon beast.* The magicians tried by their secret arts to produce gnats. But they could not. So there were gnats on man and beast.
- 19 *Then the magicians said unto Pharaoh, This is the finger of God: and Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.* Then the magicians said to Pharaoh, 'This is the finger of God.' But Pharaoh's heart was hardened. He would not listen to them, as the LORD had said.
- 20 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh; lo, he cometh forth to the water; and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Rise up early in the morning and present yourself to Pharaoh, as he goes out to the water, and say to him, Thus says the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.'

- 21 *Else, if thou wilt not let my people go, behold, I will send swarms of flies upon thee, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people, and into thy houses: and the houses of the Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies, and also the ground whereon they are.* Or else, if You will not let my people go, I will send swarms of flies on You and Your servants and Your people, and into Your houses, and the houses of the Egyptians shall be filled with swarms of flies, and also the ground on which they stand.
- 22 *And I will sever in that day the land of Goshen, in which my people dwell, that no swarms of flies shall be there; to the end thou mayest know that I am the LORD in the midst of the earth.* But on that day I will set apart the land of Goshen, where my people dwell, so that no swarms of flies shall be there, that You may know that I am the LORD in the midst of the earth.
- 23 *And I will put a division between my people and thy people: to morrow shall this sign be.* Thus I will put a division between my people and Your people. Tomorrow this sign shall happen.'
- 24 *And the LORD did so; and there came a grievous swarm of flies into the house of Pharaoh, and into his servants' houses, and into all the land of Egypt: the land was corrupted by reason of the swarm of flies.* the LORD did so. There came great swarms of flies into the house of Pharaoh and into his servants' houses. Throughout all the land of Egypt the land was ruined by the swarms of flies.
- 25 *And Pharaoh called for Moses and for Aaron, and said, Go ye, sacrifice to your God in the land.* Then Pharaoh called Moses and Aaron and said, 'Go, sacrifice to your God within the land.'
- 26 *And Moses said, It is not meet so to do; for we shall sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians to the LORD our God: lo, shall we sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians before their eyes, and will they not stone us?* But Moses said, 'It would not be right to do so, for the sacrifices we offer to the LORD our God are an abomination to the Egyptians. If we sacrifice offerings abominable to the Egyptians before their eyes, will they not stone us?'
- 27 *We will go three days' journey into the wilderness, and sacrifice to the LORD our God, as he shall command us.* We must go three days' journey into the wilderness and sacrifice to the LORD our God as He tells us.'

- 28 *And Pharaoh said, I will let you go, that ye may sacrifice to the LORD your God in the wilderness; only ye shall not go very far away: intreat for me.* So Pharaoh said, 'I will let you go to sacrifice to the LORD Your God in the wilderness; only You must not go very far away. Plead for me.'
- 29 *And Moses said, Behold, I go out from thee, and I will intreat the LORD that the swarms of flies may depart from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people, to morrow: but let not Pharaoh deal deceitfully any more in not letting the people go to sacrifice to the LORD.* Then Moses said, 'I am going out from you and I will plead with the LORD that the swarms of flies may depart from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people, tomorrow. Only let not Pharaoh cheat again by not letting the people go to sacrifice to the LORD.'
- 30 *And Moses went out from Pharaoh, and intreated the LORD.* So Moses went out from Pharaoh and prayed to the LORD.
- 31 *And the LORD did according to the word of Moses; and he removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people; there remained not one.* the LORD did as Moses asked, and removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people; not one remained.
- 32 *And Pharaoh hardened his heart at this time also, neither would he let the people go.* But Pharaoh hardened his heart this time also, and did not let the people go.

Words in this chapter:

Goshen (*GO-shen*) — The region of Egypt where the Israelites settled at Joseph's invitation — a fertile land in the eastern Nile delta; they remained there during the plagues while Egypt suffered.

Cross-References:

v6 — Ps 105:30; Ps 78:45

v8 — Ex 10:17; Ex 8:25-28; Ex 9:28

v10 — 1 Chr 17:20; 2 Sam 7:22; Isa 46:9; Ps 86:8; Deut 33:26

v12 — Jas 5:16-18; 1 Sam 12:23; Ex 32:11; Ex 9:33; Ex 10:18

v15 — Isa 26:10; Eccl 8:11; Ex 7:4; Heb 3:8; Heb 3:15

v19 — Luke 11:20; Ps 8:3

v20 — Ex 7:15

v22 — Ex 9:4; Mal 3:18; Ex 10:23; Ezek 30:19; Ex 9:6

v24 — Ps 105:31; Ps 78:45

v26 — Gen 46:34; Gen 43:32

v28 — Ex 8:8; Ex 9:28

v32 — Ex 8:15; Ex 4:21

Chapter 9

The LORD struck Egypt's livestock with a deadly plague that killed their horses, donkeys, camels, cattle, and sheep, but none of Israel's animals died; still Pharaoh's heart was hardened. Next Moses threw soot toward heaven and it became boils breaking out on man and beast throughout Egypt. Then the LORD sent a devastating hailstorm that destroyed everything in the field — except in Goshen — and Pharaoh confessed he had sinned, but hardened his heart again once the hail stopped.

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| 1 | <i>Then the LORD said unto Moses, Go in unto Pharaoh, and tell him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.</i> | Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Go in to Pharaoh and say to him, Thus says the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me. |
| 2 | <i>For if thou refuse to let them go, and wilt hold them still,</i> | For if You refuse to let them go and still hold them, |
| 3 | <i>Behold, the hand of the LORD is upon thy cattle which is in the field, upon the horses, upon the asses, upon the camels, upon the oxen, and upon the sheep: there shall be a very grievous murrain.</i> | the hand of the LORD will fall with a very severe plague upon Your livestock that are in the field, the horses, the donkeys, the camels, the herds, and the flocks. |
| 4 | <i>And the LORD shall sever between the cattle of Israel and the cattle of Egypt: and there shall nothing die of all that is the children's of Israel.</i> | But the LORD will make a distinction between the livestock of Israel and the livestock of Egypt, so that nothing of all that belongs to the children of Israel shall die.' |
| 5 | <i>And the LORD appointed a set time, saying, To morrow the LORD shall do this thing in the land.</i> | the LORD set a time, saying, 'Tomorrow the LORD will do this thing in the land.' |

- 6 *And the LORD did that thing on the morrow, and all the cattle of Egypt died: but of the cattle of the children of Israel died not one.* the next day the LORD did this thing. All the livestock of the Egyptians died, but not one of the livestock of the children of Israel died.
- 7 *And Pharaoh sent, and, behold, there was not one of the cattle of the Israelites dead. And the heart of Pharaoh was hardened, and he did not let the people go.* Pharaoh sent, and not one of the livestock of Israel was dead. But the heart of Pharaoh was hardened. He did not let the people go.
- 8 *And the LORD said unto Moses and unto Aaron, Take to you handfuls of ashes of the furnace, and let Moses sprinkle it toward the heaven in the sight of Pharaoh.* the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, 'Take handfuls of soot from the kiln, and let Moses throw them in the air in the sight of Pharaoh.
- 9 *And it shall become small dust in all the land of Egypt, and shall be a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast, throughout all the land of Egypt.* It shall become fine dust over all the land of Egypt, and become boils breaking out in sores on man and beast throughout all the land of Egypt.'
- 10 *And they took ashes of the furnace, and stood before Pharaoh; and Moses sprinkled it up toward heaven; and it became a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast.* So they took soot from the kiln and stood before Pharaoh. And Moses threw it in the air. It became boils breaking out in sores on man and beast.
- 11 *And the magicians could not stand before Moses because of the boils; for the boil was upon the magicians, and upon all the Egyptians.* the magicians could not stand before Moses because of the boils, for the boils came upon the magicians and upon all the Egyptians.
- 12 *And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh, and he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had spoken unto Moses.* But the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh. He did not listen to them, as the LORD had spoken to Moses.

- 13 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Rise up early in the morning and present yourself before Pharaoh and say to him, Thus says the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.
- 14 *For I will at this time send all my plagues upon thine heart, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people; that thou mayest know that there is none like me in all the earth.* For this time I will send all my plagues on You Yourself, and on Your servants and Your people, so that You may know that there is none like me in all the earth.
- 15 *For now I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite thee and thy people with pestilence; and thou shalt be cut off from the earth.* For by now I could have put out my hand and struck You and Your people with pestilence, and You would have been cut off from the earth.
- 16 *And in very deed for this cause have I raised thee up, for to shew in thee my power; and that my name may be declared throughout all the earth.* But for this purpose I have raised You up, to show You my power, so that my name may be proclaimed in all the earth.
- 17 *As yet exaltest thou thyself against my people, that thou wilt not let them go?* You are still exalting Yourself against my people and will not let them go.
- 18 *Behold, to morrow about this time I will cause it to rain a very grievous hail, such as hath not been in Egypt since the foundation thereof even until now.* about this time tomorrow I will cause very heavy hail to fall, such as never has been in Egypt from the day it was founded until now.
- 19 *Send therefore now, and gather thy cattle, and all that thou hast in the field; for upon every man and beast which shall be found in the field, and shall not be brought home, the hail shall come down upon them, and they shall die.* Now therefore send, get Your livestock and all that You have in the field into safe shelter, for every man and beast that is in the field and is not brought home will die when the hail falls on them.'

- 20 *He that feared the word of the LORD among the servants of Pharaoh made his servants and his cattle flee into the houses:* Then whoever feared the word of the LORD among the servants of Pharaoh hurried his slaves and his livestock into the houses,
- 21 *And he that regarded not the word of the LORD left his servants and his cattle in the field.* but whoever did not pay attention to the word of the LORD left His slaves and His livestock in the field.
- 22 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch forth thine hand toward heaven, that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt, upon man, and upon beast, and upon every herb of the field, throughout the land of Egypt.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Stretch out your hand toward heaven, so that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt, on man and beast and every plant of the field, in the land of Egypt.'
- 23 *And Moses stretched forth his rod toward heaven: and the LORD sent thunder and hail, and the fire ran along upon the ground; and the LORD rained hail upon the land of Egypt.* Then Moses stretched out his staff toward heaven. The LORD sent thunder and hail, and fire ran down to the earth. And the LORD rained hail upon the land of Egypt.
- 24 *So there was hail, and fire mingled with the hail, very grievous, such as there was none like it in all the land of Egypt since it became a nation.* There was hail and fire flashing continually in the midst of the hail, very heavy hail, such as had never been in all the land of Egypt since it became a nation.
- 25 *And the hail smote throughout all the land of Egypt all that was in the field, both man and beast; and the hail smote every herb of the field, and brake every tree of the field.* The hail struck down everything that was in the field in all the land of Egypt, both man and beast. And the hail struck down every plant of the field and broke every tree of the field.
- 26 *Only in the land of Goshen, where the children of Israel were, was there no hail.* Only in the land of Goshen, where the children of Israel were, was there no hail.

- 27 *And Pharaoh sent, and called for Moses and Aaron, and said unto them, I have sinned this time: the LORD is righteous, and I and my people are wicked.* Then Pharaoh sent and called Moses and Aaron and said to them, "This time I have sinned; the LORD is in the right. I and my people are in the wrong.
- 28 *Intreat the LORD (for it is enough) that there be no more mighty thunderings and hail; and I will let you go, and ye shall stay no longer.* Plead with the LORD, for there has been enough of God's thunder and hail. I will let You go, and You shall stay no longer.'
- 29 *And Moses said unto him, As soon as I am gone out of the city, I will spread abroad my hands unto the LORD; and the thunder shall cease, neither shall there be any more hail; that thou mayest know how that the earth is the LORD's.* Moses said to him, 'As soon as I have gone out of the city, I will stretch out my hands to the LORD. The thunder will cease, and there will be no more hail, so that You may know that the earth is the LORD's.
- 30 *But as for thee and thy servants, I know that ye will not yet fear the LORD God.* But as for You and Your servants, I know that You do not yet fear the LORD God.'
- 31 *And the flax and the barley was smitten: for the barley was in the ear, and the flax was bolled.* (The flax and the barley were struck down, for the barley was in the ear and the flax was in bud.
- 32 *But the wheat and the rie were not smitten: for they were not grown up.* But the wheat and the emmer were not struck down, for they are late in coming up.)
- 33 *And Moses went out of the city from Pharaoh, and spread abroad his hands unto the LORD: and the thunders and hail ceased, and the rain was not poured upon the earth.* So Moses went out of the city from Pharaoh and stretched out his hands to the LORD, and the thunder and the hail ceased, and the rain no longer poured upon the earth.
- 34 *And when Pharaoh saw that the rain and the hail and the thunders were ceased, he sinned yet more, and hardened his heart, he and his servants.* But when Pharaoh saw that the rain and the hail and the thunder had ceased, he sinned yet again and hardened his heart, he and his servants.

35 *And the heart of Pharaoh was hardened, neither would he let the children of Israel go; as the LORD had spoken by Moses.*

So the heart of Pharaoh was hardened. He did not let the children of Israel go, as the LORD had spoken through Moses.

Words in this chapter:

Goshen (*GO-shen*) — The region of Egypt where the Israelites settled at Joseph's invitation — a fertile land in the eastern Nile delta; they remained there during the plagues while Egypt suffered.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 8:1

v3 — Ex 7:4

v4 — Ex 8:22

v7 — Ex 7:14

v9 — Rev 16:2; Deut 28:27

v12 — Ex 4:21

v16 — Rom 9:17; Prov 16:4; Ps 83:17-18; Ps 64:9; 1 Chr 16:24

v23 — Josh 10:11; Ps 18:13; Ezek 38:22; Isa 30:30

v26 — Ex 11:7; Ex 10:23; Ex 9:4; Ex 12:13; Ex 9:6

v27 — Ps 129:4; 2 Chr 12:6; Lam 1:18; Ex 10:16

v29 — 1 Kgs 8:22; 1 Kgs 8:38; Isa 1:15; Ps 143:6; 1 Cor 10:26

v30 — Isa 26:10

Chapter 10

The LORD sent a plague of locusts that devoured every plant left after the hail, covering the face of the whole earth until the land was darkened; Pharaoh begged Moses to remove them, but again hardened his heart. The LORD then sent three days of thick darkness over all Egypt so that no one could see or move, while the children of Israel had light in their dwellings. Pharaoh offered to let the people go but demanded their livestock stay, and Moses refused; Pharaoh then threatened Moses with death if he saw his face again.

1 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Go in unto Pharaoh: for I have hardened his heart, and the heart of his servants, that I might shew these my signs before him:* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Go in to Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart and the heart of his servants, that I may show these signs of mine among them,

- 2 *And that thou mayest tell in the ears of thy son, and of thy son's son, what things I have wrought in Egypt, and my signs which I have done among them; that ye may know how that I am the LORD.* that You may tell in the hearing of Your son and Your grandson how I have dealt harshly with the Egyptians and what signs I have done among them, that You may know that I am the LORD.'
- 3 *And Moses and Aaron came in unto Pharaoh, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, How long wilt thou refuse to humble thyself before me? let my people go, that they may serve me.* So Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh and said to him, 'Thus says the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, How long will You refuse to humble Yourself before me? Let my people go, that they may serve me.
- 4 *Else, if thou refuse to let my people go, behold, to morrow will I bring the locusts into thy coast:* For if You refuse to let my people go, tomorrow I will bring locusts into Your country,
- 5 *And they shall cover the face of the earth, that one cannot be able to see the earth: and they shall eat the residue of that which is escaped, which remaineth unto you from the hail, and shall eat every tree which groweth for you out of the field:* they shall cover the face of the land, so that no one can see the land. And they shall eat what is left to You after the hail. They shall eat every tree of Yours that grows in the field.
- 6 *And they shall fill thy houses, and the houses of all thy servants, and the houses of all the Egyptians; which neither thy fathers, nor thy fathers' fathers have seen, since the day that they were upon the earth unto this day. And he turned himself, and went out from Pharaoh.* they shall fill your houses and the houses of all your servants and of all the Egyptians, as neither your fathers nor your grandfathers have seen, from the day they came on earth to this day.' Then he turned and went out from Pharaoh.

- 7 *And Pharaoh's servants said unto him, How long shall this man be a snare unto us? let the men go, that they may serve the LORD their God: knowest thou not yet that Egypt is destroyed?* Then Pharaoh's servants said to him, 'How long shall this man be a snare to us? Let the men go, that they may serve the LORD their God. Do You not yet understand that Egypt is ruined?'
- 8 *And Moses and Aaron were brought again unto Pharaoh: and he said unto them, Go, serve the LORD your God: but who are they that shall go?* So Moses and Aaron were brought back to Pharaoh. And he said to them, 'Go, serve the LORD Your God. But which ones are to go?'
- 9 *And Moses said, We will go with our young and with our old, with our sons and with our daughters, with our flocks and with our herds will we go; for we must hold a feast unto the LORD.* Moses said, 'We will go with our young and our old. We will go with our sons and daughters and with our flocks and herds, for we must hold a feast to the LORD.'
- 10 *And he said unto them, Let the LORD be so with you, as I will let you go, and your little ones: look to it; for evil is before you.* But He said to them, 'The LORD be with You, if ever I let You and Your little ones go! Look, You have some evil purpose in mind.'
- 11 *Not so: go now ye that are men, and serve the LORD; for that ye did desire. And they were driven out from Pharaoh's presence.* No! Go, the men among You, and serve the LORD, for that is what You are asking.' And they were driven out from Pharaoh's presence.
- 12 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand over the land of Egypt for the locusts, that they may come up upon the land of Egypt, and eat every herb of the land, even all that the hail hath left.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Stretch out your hand over the land of Egypt for the locusts, so that they may come upon the land of Egypt and eat every plant in the land, all that the hail has left.'

- 13 *And Moses stretched forth his rod over the land of Egypt, and the LORD brought an east wind upon the land all that day, and all that night; and when it was morning, the east wind brought the locusts.* So Moses stretched out his staff over the land of Egypt. The LORD brought an east wind upon the land all that day and all that night. When it was morning, the east wind had brought the locusts.
- 14 *And the locusts went up over all the land of Egypt, and rested in all the coasts of Egypt: very grievous were they; before them there were no such locusts as they, neither after them shall be such.* The locusts came up over all the land of Egypt and settled on the whole country of Egypt, such a dense swarm of locusts as had never been before, nor ever will be again.
- 15 *For they covered the face of the whole earth, so that the land was darkened; and they did eat every herb of the land, and all the fruit of the trees which the hail had left: and there remained not any green thing in the trees, or in the herbs of the field, through all the land of Egypt.* They covered the face of the whole land, so that the land was darkened. They ate all the plants in the land and all the fruit of the trees that the hail had left. Not a green thing remained, neither tree nor plant of the field, through all the land of Egypt.
- 16 *Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron in haste; and he said, I have sinned against the LORD your God, and against you.* Then Pharaoh hastily called Moses and Aaron and said, 'I have sinned against the LORD Your God, and against You.
- 17 *Now therefore forgive, I pray thee, my sin only this once, and intreat the LORD your God, that he may take away from me this death only.* Now therefore, forgive my sin, please, only this once, and plead with the LORD Your God only to remove this death from me.'
- 18 *And he went out from Pharaoh, and intreated the LORD.* So He went out from Pharaoh and pleaded with the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE** Red sea (RED SEE) — "Sea of Reeds (Hebrew)" Body of water where Israel would cross on dry ground after the final plague. Here the west wind drives the locust plague into it.

- 19 *And the LORD turned a mighty strong west wind, which took away the locusts, and cast them into the Red sea; there remained not one locust in all the coasts of Egypt.* the LORD turned the wind into a very strong west wind, which lifted the locusts and drove them into the Red Sea. Not a single locust was left in all the country of Egypt.
- 20 *But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go.* But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart. He did not let the children of Israel go.
- 21 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand toward heaven, that there may be darkness over the land of Egypt, even darkness which may be felt.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Stretch out your hand toward heaven, that there may be darkness over the land of Egypt, a darkness to be felt.'
- 22 *And Moses stretched forth his hand toward heaven; and there was a thick darkness in all the land of Egypt three days:* So Moses stretched out his hand toward heaven, and there was pitch darkness in all the land of Egypt three days.
- 23 *They saw not one another, neither rose any from his place for three days: but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings.* They did not see one another, nor did anyone rise from his place for three days. But all the children of Israel had light where they lived.
- 24 *And Pharaoh called unto Moses, and said, Go ye, serve the LORD; only let your flocks and your herds be stayed: let your little ones also go with you.* Then Pharaoh called Moses and said, 'Go, serve the LORD; Your little ones also may go with You; only let Your flocks and Your herds remain behind.'
- 25 *And Moses said, Thou must give us also sacrifices and burnt offerings, that we may sacrifice unto the LORD our God.* But Moses said, 'You must also let us have sacrifices and burnt offerings, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.'
- 26 *Our cattle also shall go with us; there shall not an hoof be left behind; for thereof must we take to serve the LORD our God; and we know not with what we must serve the LORD, until we come thither.* Our livestock also must go with us; not a hoof shall be left behind, for we must take of them to serve the LORD our God. We do not know with what we must serve the LORD until we arrive there.'

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| 27 | <i>But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let them go.</i> | But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart. He would not let them go. |
| 28 | <i>And Pharaoh said unto him, Get thee from me, take heed to thyself, see my face no more; for in that day thou seest my face thou shalt die.</i> | Then Pharaoh said to him, 'Get away from me; take care never to see my face again, for on the day you see my face you shall die.' |
| 29 | <i>And Moses said, Thou hast spoken well, I will see thy face again no more.</i> | Moses said, 'As you say! I will not see your face again.' |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Joel 1:3; Deut 4:9; Deut 6:20-22; Ex 13:14
- v3 — 1 Pet 5:6; 1 Kgs 21:29; Jas 4:10
- v7 — 1 Sam 18:21
- v9 — 1 Cor 5:7-8; Ex 5:1; Deut 31:12-13
- v14 — Ps 78:46
- v16 — Ex 9:27
- v17 — Ex 8:8
- v20 — Ex 4:21
- v22 — Ps 105:28; Rev 16:10
- v23 — Ex 8:22
- v27 — Ex 10:20
- v29 — Heb 11:27

Chapter 11

The LORD told Moses he would bring one final plague on Egypt, after which Pharaoh would drive them out completely; the people were to ask their Egyptian neighbors for silver and gold jewelry. Moses announced to Pharaoh that at midnight the LORD would go through Egypt and every firstborn in the land would die, from Pharaoh's heir to the servant's child, but not a dog would stir against Israel.

- 1 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Yet will I bring one plague more upon Pharaoh, and upon Egypt; afterwards he will let you go hence: when he shall let you go, he shall surely thrust you out hence altogether.* The LORD said to Moses, 'Yet one plague more I will bring upon Pharaoh and upon Egypt. Afterward he will let you go from here. When he lets you go, he will drive you away completely.
- 2 *Speak now in the ears of the people, and let every man borrow of his neighbour, and every woman of her neighbour, jewels of silver, and jewels of gold.* Speak now in the hearing of the people, that they ask, every man of his neighbor and every woman of her neighbor, for silver and gold jewelry.'
- 3 *And the LORD gave the people favour in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover the man Moses was very great in the land of Egypt, in the sight of Pharaoh's servants, and in the sight of the people.* the LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover, the man Moses was very great in the land of Egypt, in the sight of Pharaoh's servants and in the sight of the people.
- 4 *And Moses said, Thus saith the LORD, About midnight will I go out into the midst of Egypt:* So Moses said, 'Thus says the LORD, About midnight I will go out in the midst of Egypt,
- 5 *And all the firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh that sitteth upon his throne, even unto the firstborn of the maidservant that is behind the mill; and all the firstborn of beasts.* every firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne, even to the firstborn of the slave girl who is behind the mill, and all the firstborn of the livestock.
- 6 *And there shall be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as there was none like it, nor shall be like it any more.* There shall be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as there has never been, nor ever will be again.

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| <p>7 <i>But against any of the children of Israel shall not a dog move his tongue, against man or beast: that ye may know how that the LORD doth put a difference between the Egyptians and Israel.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And all these thy servants shall come down unto me, and bow down themselves unto me, saying, Get thee out, and all the people that follow thee: and after that I will go out. And he went out from Pharaoh in a great anger.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you; that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh: and the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go out of his land.</i></p> | <p>But not a dog shall growl against any of the children of Israel, either man or beast, that You may know that the LORD makes a distinction between Egypt and Israel.</p> <p>all these your servants shall come down to me and bow down to me, saying, Get out, you and all the people who follow you. And after that I will go out.' And he went out from Pharaoh in hot anger.</p> <p>Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Pharaoh will not listen to you, that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt.'</p> <p>Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh. The LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart. He did not let the children of Israel go out of His land.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 15:14; Lev 26:21
- v2 — Ex 3:22
- v3 — Ex 12:36; Ex 3:21
- v4 — Ex 12:29; Amos 4:10; Ps 60:10; Ex 12:12; Job 34:20
- v5 — Ps 78:51
- v6 — Ex 12:30
- v7 — Josh 10:21; Ex 8:22; Mal 3:18; Ex 10:23; Ex 9:4
- v8 — Ex 12:31-33
- v9 — Ex 7:3-4

v10 — Ex 4:21

Chapter 12

The LORD instituted the Passover: each household was to take a lamb without blemish, kill it at twilight, and strike its blood on the doorposts and lintel so that the destroyer would pass over when he struck Egypt's firstborn. At midnight the LORD killed every firstborn in Egypt, from Pharaoh's son to the captive's son, and there was a great cry; Pharaoh urgently sent Israel away that very night. About 600,000 men on foot besides children departed, along with a mixt multitude, taking their unleavened dough and the silver and gold of the Egyptians.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying,</i> | The LORD said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, |
| 2 | <i>This month shall be unto you the beginning of months: it shall be the first month of the year to you.</i> | "This month shall be for You the beginning of months. It shall be the first month of the year for You. |
| 3 | <i>Speak ye unto all the congregation of Israel, saying, In the tenth day of this month they shall take to them every man a lamb, according to the house of their fathers, a lamb for an house:</i> | Tell all the congregation of Israel that on the tenth day of this month every man shall take a lamb according to their fathers' houses, a lamb for a household. |
| 4 | <i>And if the household be too little for the lamb, let him and his neighbour next unto his house take it according to the number of the souls; every man according to his eating shall make your count for the lamb.</i> | if the household is too small for a lamb, then He and His nearest neighbor shall take according to the number of persons; according to what each can eat You shall make Your count for the lamb. |
| 5 | <i>Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male of the first year: ye shall take it out from the sheep, or from the goats:</i> | Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male a year old. You may take it from the sheep or from the goats, |
| 6 | <i>And ye shall keep it up until the fourteenth day of the same month: and the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it in the evening.</i> | you shall keep it until the fourteenth day of this month, when the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill their lambs at twilight. |

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| 7 | <i>And they shall take of the blood, and strike it on the two side posts and on the upper door post of the houses, wherein they shall eat it.</i> | Then they shall take some of the blood and put it on the two doorposts and the lintel of the houses in which they eat it. |
| 8 | <i>And they shall eat the flesh in that night, roast with fire, and unleavened bread; and with bitter herbs they shall eat it.</i> | They shall eat the flesh that night, roasted on the fire; with unleavened bread and bitter herbs they shall eat it. |
| 9 | <i>Eat not of it raw, nor sodden at all with water, but roast with fire; his head with his legs, and with the purtenance thereof.</i> | Do not eat any of it raw or boiled in water, but roasted, its head with its legs and its inner parts. |
| 10 | <i>And ye shall let nothing of it remain until the morning; and that which remaineth of it until the morning ye shall burn with fire.</i> | you shall let none of it remain until the morning; anything that remains until the morning You shall burn with fire. |

■ **NAME NOTE** *Passover (PASS-oh-ver) — "To pass over, spare" The feast commemorating the night God passed over the blood-marked houses of Israel while striking the firstborn of Egypt. The foundational Jewish feast; prefigures Christ as the Passover Lamb.*

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| 11 | <i>And thus shall ye eat it; with your loins girded, your shoes on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and ye shall eat it in haste: it is the LORD's passover.</i> | In this manner You shall eat it: with Your belt fastened, Your sandals on Your feet, and Your staff in Your hand. And You shall eat it in haste. It is the LORD's Passover. |
| 12 | <i>For I will pass through the land of Egypt this night, and will smite all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast; and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgment: I am the LORD.</i> | For I will pass through the land of Egypt that night. I will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast. On all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgments. I am the LORD. |

- 13 *And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you, and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I smite the land of Egypt.* The blood shall be a sign for You, on the houses where You are. And when I see the blood, I will pass over You, and no plague will befall You to destroy You, when I strike the land of Egypt.
- 14 *And this day shall be unto you for a memorial; and ye shall keep it a feast to the LORD throughout your generations; ye shall keep it a feast by an ordinance for ever.* This day shall be for You a memorial day, and You shall keep it as a feast to the LORD; throughout Your generations, as a statute forever, You shall keep it as a feast.
- 15 *Seven days shall ye eat unleavened bread; even the first day ye shall put away leaven out of your houses: for whosoever eateth leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel.* Seven days You shall eat unleavened bread. On the first day You shall remove leaven out of Your houses, for if anyone eats what is leavened, from the first day until the seventh day, that person shall be cut off from Israel.
- 16 *And in the first day there shall be an holy convocation, and in the seventh day there shall be an holy convocation to you; no manner of work shall be done in them, save that which every man must eat, that only may be done of you.* On the first day You shall hold a holy assembly, and on the seventh day a holy assembly. No work shall be done on those days. But what everyone needs to eat, that alone may be prepared by You.
- 17 *And ye shall observe the feast of unleavened bread; for in this selfsame day have I brought your armies out of the land of Egypt: therefore shall ye observe this day in your generations by an ordinance for ever.* you shall observe the Feast of Unleavened Bread, for on this very day I brought Your hosts out of the land of Egypt. Therefore You shall observe this day throughout Your generations as a statute forever.

- 18 *In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at even, ye shall eat unleavened bread, until the one and twentieth day of the month at even.* In the first month, from the fourteenth day of the month at evening, You shall eat unleavened bread until the twenty-first day of the month at evening.
- 19 *Seven days shall there be no leaven found in your houses: for whosoever eateth that which is leavened, even that soul shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether he be a stranger, or born in the land.* For seven days no leaven is to be found in Your houses. If anyone eats what is leavened, that person shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether He is a sojourner or a native of the land.
- 20 *Ye shall eat nothing leavened; in all your habitations shall ye eat unleavened bread.* You shall eat nothing leavened; in all Your dwelling places You shall eat unleavened bread.'
- 21 *Then Moses called for all the elders of Israel, and said unto them, Draw out and take you a lamb according to your families, and kill the passover.* Then Moses called all the elders of Israel and said to them, 'Go and select lambs for yourselves according to your clans, and kill the Passover lamb.
- 22 *And ye shall take a bunch of hyssop, and dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and strike the lintel and the two side posts with the blood that is in the basin; and none of you shall go out at the door of his house until the morning.* Take a bunch of hyssop and dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and touch the lintel and the two doorposts with the blood that is in the basin. None of you shall go out of the door of his house until the morning.
- 23 *For the LORD will pass through to smite the Egyptians; and when he seeth the blood upon the lintel, and on the two side posts, the LORD will pass over the door, and will not suffer the destroyer to come in unto your houses to smite you.* For the LORD will pass through to strike the Egyptians, and when He sees the blood on the lintel and on the two doorposts, the LORD will pass over the door and will not allow the destroyer to enter Your houses to strike You.
- 24 *And ye shall observe this thing for an ordinance to thee and to thy sons for ever.* You shall observe this rite as a statute for You and for Your sons forever.

- 25 *And it shall come to pass, when ye be come to the land which the LORD will give you, according as he hath promised, that ye shall keep this service.* when You come to the land that the LORD will give You, as He has promised, You shall keep this service.
- 26 *And it shall come to pass, when your children shall say unto you, What mean ye by this service?* when Your children say to You, What do You mean by this service?
- 27 *That ye shall say, It is the sacrifice of the LORD's passover, who passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, when he smote the Egyptians, and delivered our houses. And the people bowed the head and worshipped.* you shall say, It is the sacrifice of the LORD's Passover, for He passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, when He struck the Egyptians but spared our houses.' And the people bowed their heads and worshiped.
- 28 *And the children of Israel went away, and did as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron, so did they.* Then the children of Israel went and did so; as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did.
- 29 *And it came to pass, that at midnight the LORD smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh that sat on his throne unto the firstborn of the captive that was in the dungeon; and all the firstborn of cattle.* At midnight the LORD struck down all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sat on his throne to the firstborn of the captive who was in the dungeon, and all the firstborn of the livestock.
- 30 *And Pharaoh rose up in the night, he, and all his servants, and all the Egyptians; and there was a great cry in Egypt; for there was not a house where there was not one dead.* Pharaoh rose up in the night, he and all his servants and all the Egyptians. And there was a great cry in Egypt, for there was not a house where someone was not dead.
- 31 *And he called for Moses and Aaron by night, and said, Rise up, and get you forth from among my people, both ye and the children of Israel; and go, serve the LORD, as ye have said.* Then He summoned Moses and Aaron by night and said, 'Up, go out from among my people, both You and the children of Israel. Go, serve the LORD, as You have said.

- 32 *Also take your flocks and your herds, as ye have said, and be gone; and bless me also.* Take Your flocks and Your herds, as You have said, and be gone, and bless me also!"
- 33 *And the Egyptians were urgent upon the people, that they might send them out of the land in haste; for they said, We be all dead men.* The Egyptians were urgent with the people to send them out of the land in haste, for they said, 'We shall all be dead.'
- 34 *And the people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneadingtroughs being bound up in their clothes upon their shoulders.* So the people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneading bowls being bound up in their cloaks on their shoulders.
- 35 *And the children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they borrowed of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment:* The children of Israel had also done as Moses told them, for they had asked the Egyptians for silver and gold jewelry and for clothing.
- 36 *And the LORD gave the people favour in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they lent unto them such things as they required. And they spoiled the Egyptians.* the LORD had given the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they let them have what they asked. Thus they plundered the Egyptians.
- 37 *And the children of Israel journeyed from Rameses to Succoth, about six hundred thousand on foot that were men, beside children.* the children of Israel journeyed from Rameses to Succoth, about 600,000 men on foot, besides women and children.
- 38 *And a mixed multitude went up also with them; and flocks, and herds, even very much cattle.* A mixed crowd also went up with them, and very much livestock, both flocks and herds.
- 39 *And they baked unleavened cakes of the dough which they brought forth out of Egypt, for it was not leavened; because they were thrust out of Egypt, and could not tarry, neither had they prepared for themselves any victual.* they baked unleavened cakes of the dough that they had brought out of Egypt, for it was not leavened, because they were thrust out of Egypt and could not wait, nor had they prepared any provisions for themselves.

- 40 *Now the sojourning of the children of Israel, who dwelt in Egypt, was four hundred and thirty years.* The time that the children of Israel lived in Egypt was 430 years.
- 41 *And it came to pass at the end of the four hundred and thirty years, even the selfsame day it came to pass, that all the hosts of the LORD went out from the land of Egypt.* At the end of 430 years, on that very day, all the hosts of the LORD went out from the land of Egypt.
- 42 *It is a night to be much observed unto the LORD for bringing them out from the land of Egypt: this is that night of the LORD to be observed of all the children of Israel in their generations.* It was a night of watching by the LORD, to bring them out of the land of Egypt; so this same night is a night of watching kept to the LORD by all the children of Israel throughout their generations.
- 43 *And the LORD said unto Moses and Aaron, This is the ordinance of the passover: There shall no stranger eat thereof:* the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the statute of the Passover: no foreigner shall eat of it,
- 44 *But every man's servant that is bought for money, when thou hast circumcised him, then shall he eat thereof.* but every slave that is bought for money may eat of it after You have circumcised Him.
- 45 *A foreigner and an hired servant shall not eat thereof.* No foreigner or hired servant may eat of it.
- 46 *In one house shall it be eaten; thou shalt not carry forth ought of the flesh abroad out of the house; neither shall ye break a bone thereof.* It shall be eaten in one house; You shall not take any of the flesh outside the house, and You shall not break any of its bones.
- 47 *All the congregation of Israel shall keep it.* All the congregation of Israel shall keep it.

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| <p>48 <i>And when a stranger shall sojourn with thee, and will keep the passover to the LORD, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it; and he shall be as one that is born in the land: for no uncircumcised person shall eat thereof.</i></p> <p>49 <i>One law shall be to him that is homeborn, and unto the stranger that sojourneth among you.</i></p> <p>50 <i>Thus did all the children of Israel; as the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron, so did they.</i></p> <p>51 <i>And it came to pass the selfsame day, that the LORD did bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their armies.</i></p> | <p>If a stranger shall stay with You and would keep the Passover to the LORD, let all His males be circumcised. Then He may come near and keep it; He shall be as a native of the land. But no uncircumcised person shall eat of it.</p> <p>There shall be one law for the native and for the stranger who sojourns among You.'</p> <p>All the children of Israel did just as the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron.</p> <p>on that very day the LORD brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their hosts.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Ex 13:4; Deut 16:1; Ex 34:18; Ex 23:15; Lev 23:5
v5 — Heb 9:13-14; 1 Pet 1:18-19; Mal 1:14; Mal 1:7-8; Deut 17:1
v6 — Lev 23:5; Num 28:16; 2 Chr 30:15-18; Num 9:11; Ex 12:18
v7 — Heb 11:28; Ex 12:22-23; Heb 9:22; Eph 1:7
v11 — Eph 6:15; Ex 12:27; 1 Pet 1:13; 1 Cor 5:7; Luke 12:35
v12 — Num 33:4; Ps 82:6; Ex 12:23; Isa 19:1; Jer 43:13
v13 — Heb 11:28; Ex 12:23; 1 John 1:7; Gen 17:11; Josh 2:12
v14 — 2 Kgs 23:21; Ex 13:9-10; Ex 12:24; Ex 12:17; 1 Cor 5:7-8
v23 — Rev 7:3; Rev 9:4; Heb 11:28; Ex 12:12-13; 1 Cor 10:10
v29 — Ps 78:51; Ex 4:23; Ps 135:8; Ps 105:36; Ex 11:4-5
v35 — Ex 3:21-22; Ex 11:2-3; Gen 15:14; Ps 105:37
v36 — Gen 15:14; Acts 7:10; Ex 3:21-22; Ps 105:37; Ex 11:3

Chapter 13

The LORD commanded that all firstborn be consecrated to him and that Israel keep the feast of unleavened bread as a memorial of the Exodus, teaching it to their children as a sign on their hand and frontlets between their eyes. God did not lead them by the shorter way through the Philistines' land lest the people turn back at the sight of war, but led them through the wilderness toward the Red sea. The LORD went before them by day in a pillar of cloud and by night in a pillar of fire.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD said to Moses, |
| 2 <i>Sanctify unto me all the firstborn, whatsoever openeth the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of beast: it is mine.</i> | 'Consecrate to me all the firstborn. Whatever is the first to open the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of beast, is mine.' |
| 3 <i>And Moses said unto the people, Remember this day, in which ye came out from Egypt, out of the house of bondage; for by strength of hand the LORD brought you out from this place: there shall no leavened bread be eaten.</i> | Then Moses said to the people, 'Remember this day in which you came out from Egypt, out of the house of slavery, for by a strong hand the LORD brought you out from this place. No leavened bread shall be eaten.' |

■ **NAME NOTE** Abib (AY-bib) — "Green ears (of grain)" The first month of the Hebrew sacred calendar, roughly March-April. Later called Nisan. The month of the Exodus.

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| 4 <i>This day came ye out in the month Abib.</i> | Today, in the month of Abib, You are going out. |
| 5 <i>And it shall be when the LORD shall bring thee into the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, which he sware unto thy fathers to give thee, a land flowing with milk and honey, that thou shalt keep this service in this month.</i> | when the LORD brings You into the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, which He swore to Your fathers to give You, a land flowing with milk and honey, You shall keep this service in this month. |
| 6 <i>Seven days thou shalt eat unleavened bread, and in the seventh day shall be a feast to the LORD.</i> | Seven days You shall eat unleavened bread, and on the seventh day there shall be a feast to the LORD. |

- 7 *Unleavened bread shall be eaten seven days; and there shall no leavened bread be seen with thee, neither shall there be leaven seen with thee in all thy quarters.* Unleavened bread shall be eaten for seven days; no leavened bread shall be seen with You, and no leaven shall be seen with You in all Your territory.
- 8 *And thou shalt shew thy son in that day, saying, This is done because of that which the LORD did unto me when I came forth out of Egypt.* You shall tell Your son on that day, It is because of what the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.
- 9 *And it shall be for a sign unto thee upon thine hand, and for a memorial between thine eyes, that the LORD's law may be in thy mouth: for with a strong hand hath the LORD brought thee out of Egypt.* it shall be to You as a sign on Your hand and as a memorial between Your eyes, that the law of the LORD may be in Your mouth. For with a strong hand the LORD has brought You out of Egypt.
- 10 *Thou shalt therefore keep this ordinance in his season from year to year.* You shall therefore keep this statute at its appointed time from year to year.
- 11 *And it shall be when the LORD shall bring thee into the land of the Canaanites, as he sware unto thee and to thy fathers, and shall give it thee,* When the LORD brings You into the land of the Canaanites, as He swore to You and Your fathers, and shall give it to You,
- 12 *That thou shalt set apart unto the LORD all that openeth the matrix, and every firstling that cometh of a beast which thou hast; the males shall be the LORD's.* you shall set apart to the LORD all that first opens the womb. All the firstborn of Your animals that are males shall be the LORD's.
- 13 *And every firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb; and if thou wilt not redeem it, then thou shalt break his neck: and all the firstborn of man among thy children shalt thou redeem.* Every firstborn of a donkey You shall redeem with a lamb, or if You will not redeem it You shall break its neck. Every firstborn of man among Your sons You shall redeem.

- 14 *And it shall be when thy son asketh thee in time to come, saying, What is this? that thou shalt say unto him, By strength of hand the LORD brought us out from Egypt, from the house of bondage:* when in time to come Your son asks You, What does this mean? you shall say to Him, By a strong hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt, from the house of slavery.
- 15 *And it came to pass, when Pharaoh would hardly let us go, that the LORD slew all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of beast: therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that openeth the matrix, being males; but all the firstborn of my children I redeem.* For when Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man and the firstborn of animals. Therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all the males that first open the womb. But all the firstborn of my sons I redeem.
- 16 *And it shall be for a token upon thine hand, and for frontlets between thine eyes: for by strength of hand the LORD brought us forth out of Egypt.* It shall be as a mark on Your hand and as frontlets between Your eyes, for by a strong hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt.'
- 17 *And it came to pass, when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God led them not through the way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near; for God said, Lest peradventure the people repent when they see war, and they return to Egypt:* When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them by way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near. For God said, 'Lest the people change their minds when they see war and return to Egypt.'
- 18 *But God led the people about, through the way of the wilderness of the Red sea: and the children of Israel went up harnessed out of the land of Egypt.* But God led the people around by the way of the wilderness toward the Red Sea. And the children of Israel went up out of the land of Egypt equipped for battle.
- 19 *And Moses took the bones of Joseph with him: for he had straitly sworn the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you; and ye shall carry up my bones away hence with you.* Moses took the bones of Joseph with him, for Joseph had made the children of Israel solemnly swear, saying, 'God will surely visit you, and you shall carry my bones with you from here.'

■ **NAME NOTE** *Etham (EE-tham)* — "With them, their boundary" Second encampment of Israel after leaving Rameses. On the edge of the wilderness.

20	<i>And they took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness.</i>	they moved on from Succoth and encamped at Etham, on the edge of the wilderness.
21	<i>And the LORD went before them by day in a pillar of a cloud, to lead them the way; and by night in a pillar of fire, to give them light; to go by day and night:</i>	the LORD went before them by day in a pillar of cloud to lead them along the way, and by night in a pillar of fire to give them light, that they might travel by day and by night.
22	<i>He took not away the pillar of the cloud by day, nor the pillar of fire by night, from before the people.</i>	The pillar of cloud by day and the pillar of fire by night did not depart from before the people.

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Luke 2:23; Num 3:13; Deut 15:19; Ex 22:29-30; Num 8:16-17
- v3 — Deut 24:18; Deut 5:15; Ex 20:2; Deut 5:6; Deut 16:12
- v4 — Ex 34:18; Ex 23:15; Ex 12:2
- v5 — Ex 3:8; Josh 24:11; Ex 12:25-26; Ex 6:8
- v9 — Deut 6:8; Deut 11:18-19; Ex 13:16; Num 15:39; Ex 12:14
- v12 — Num 18:15; Lev 27:26; Ex 34:19; Ezek 44:30
- v14 — Josh 4:6; Ex 13:3
- v15 — Ex 12:29
- v16 — Ex 13:9
- v17 — Ex 14:11-12; Neh 9:17; Num 14:1-4; Luke 14:27-32; 1 Kgs 8:47
- v19 — Gen 50:24-25; Josh 24:32; Acts 7:16; Gen 48:21
- v21 — 1 Cor 10:1-2; Neh 9:12; Ps 99:7; Deut 1:33; Ps 105:39

Chapter 14

God hardened Pharaoh's heart so that he pursued Israel with his chariots to the shore of the Red sea; the people cried out in fear, but Moses said the LORD would fight for them. The LORD told Moses to stretch out his staff, and a strong east wind divided the sea all night so that Israel walked through on dry ground with walls of water on each side. When the Egyptians

pursued, the LORD threw their army into confusion, and the waters returned and drowned Pharaoh's entire host; Israel saw the great work and feared the LORD and believed him and his servant Moses.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses,* Then the LORD said to Moses,
saying,

■ **NAME NOTE** *Pihahiroth (pie-ha-HI-roth) — "Mouth of the gorges" Location between Migdol and the Red Sea where Israel camped before the crossing. Migdol (MIG-dol) — "Tower, fortress" Egyptian fortress on the eastern border, near where Israel crossed the Red Sea. Baalzephon (BAY-al-ZEE-fon) — "Lord of the north (a Canaanite storm god)" Place near Israel's Red Sea crossing, named for a pagan deity. God's deliverance came right in front of this shrine.*

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| <p>2 <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, that they turn and encamp before Pihahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, over against Baalzephon: before it shall ye encamp by the sea.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel, They are entangled in the land, the wilderness hath shut them in.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And I will harden Pharaoh's heart, that he shall follow after them; and I will be honoured upon Pharaoh, and upon all his host; that the Egyptians may know that I am the LORD. And they did so.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And it was told the king of Egypt that the people fled: and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was turned against the people, and they said, Why have we done this, that we have let Israel go from serving us?</i></p> <p>6 <i>And he made ready his chariot, and took his people with him:</i></p> | <p>'Tell the children of Israel to turn back and encamp in front of Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, in front of Baal-zephon; You shall encamp facing it, by the sea.</p> <p>For Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel, They are wandering in the land; the wilderness has shut them in.</p> <p>I will harden Pharaoh's heart. He will pursue them. I will get glory over Pharaoh and all his host, and the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD.' And they did so.</p> <p>When the king of Egypt was told that the people had fled, the mind of Pharaoh and his servants was changed toward the people. They said, 'What is this we have done, that we have let Israel go from serving us?'</p> <p>So he made ready his chariot and took his army with him,</p> |
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- 7 *And he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, and captains over every one of them.* took 600 chosen chariots and all the other chariots of Egypt with officers over all of them.
- 8 *And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued after the children of Israel: and the children of Israel went out with an high hand.* the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt. He pursued the children of Israel while the children of Israel were going out defiantly.
- 9 *But the Egyptians pursued after them, all the horses and chariots of Pharaoh, and his horsemen, and his army, and overtook them encamping by the sea, beside Pihahiroth, before Baalzephon.* The Egyptians pursued them, all Pharaoh's horses and chariots and his horsemen and his army, and overtook them encamped at the sea, by Pi-hahiroth, in front of Baal-zephon.
- 10 *And when Pharaoh drew nigh, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and, behold, the Egyptians marched after them; and they were sore afraid: and the children of Israel cried out unto the LORD.* When Pharaoh drew near, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and the Egyptians were marching after them. They feared greatly. And the children of Israel cried out to the LORD.
- 11 *And they said unto Moses, Because there were no graves in Egypt, hast thou taken us away to die in the wilderness? wherefore hast thou dealt thus with us, to carry us forth out of Egypt?* They said to Moses, 'Is it because there are no graves in Egypt that you have taken us away to die in the wilderness? What have you done to us in bringing us out of Egypt?
- 12 *Is not this the word that we did tell thee in Egypt, saying, Let us alone, that we may serve the Egyptians? For it had been better for us to serve the Egyptians, than that we should die in the wilderness.* Is not this what we said to you in Egypt, Leave us alone that we may serve the Egyptians? For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in the wilderness.'

- 13 *And Moses said unto the people, Fear ye not, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will shew to you to day: for the Egyptians whom ye have seen to day, ye shall see them again no more for ever.* Moses said to the people, 'Fear not, stand firm, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today. For the Egyptians whom you see today, you shall never see again.
- 14 *The LORD shall fight for you, and ye shall hold your peace.* The LORD will fight for You, and You have only to be silent.'
- 15 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Wherefore criest thou unto me? speak unto the children of Israel, that they go forward:* The LORD said to Moses, 'Why do you cry to me? Tell the children of Israel to go forward.
- 16 *But lift thou up thy rod, and stretch out thine hand over the sea, and divide it: and the children of Israel shall go on dry ground through the midst of the sea.* Lift up Your staff, and stretch out Your hand over the sea and divide it, that the children of Israel may go through the sea on dry ground.
- 17 *And I, behold, I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they shall follow them: and I will get me honour upon Pharaoh, and upon all his host, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.* I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians so that they shall go in after them. I will get glory over Pharaoh and all his host, his chariots and his horsemen.
- 18 *And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I have gotten me honour upon Pharaoh, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.* the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I have gotten glory over Pharaoh, his chariots and his horsemen.'
- 19 *And the angel of God, which went before the camp of Israel, removed and went behind them; and the pillar of the cloud went from before their face, and stood behind them:* Then the angel of God Who was going before the host of Israel moved and went behind them, and the pillar of cloud moved from before them and stood behind them,

- 20 *And it came between the camp of the Egyptians and the camp of Israel; and it was a cloud and darkness to them, but it gave light by night to these: so that the one came not near the other all the night.* coming between the host of Egypt and the host of Israel. And there was the cloud and the darkness. And it lit up the night without one coming near the other all night.
- 21 *And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided.* Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea. The LORD drove the sea back by a strong east wind all night and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided.
- 22 *And the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea upon the dry ground: and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.* the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea on dry ground, the waters being a wall to them on their right hand and on their left.
- 23 *And the Egyptians pursued, and went in after them to the midst of the sea, even all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen.* The Egyptians pursued and went in after them into the midst of the sea, all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots and his horsemen.
- 24 *And it came to pass, that in the morning watch the LORD looked unto the host of the Egyptians through the pillar of fire and of the cloud, and troubled the host of the Egyptians,* in the morning watch the LORD in the pillar of fire and of cloud looked down on the Egyptian forces and threw the Egyptian forces into a panic,
- 25 *And took off their chariot wheels, that they drave them heavily: so that the Egyptians said, Let us flee from the face of Israel; for the LORD fighteth for them against the Egyptians.* clogging their chariot wheels so that they drove heavily. And the Egyptians said, 'Let us flee from before Israel, for the LORD fights for them against the Egyptians.'
- 26 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots, and upon their horsemen.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the water may come back upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots, and upon their horsemen.'

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| <p>27 <i>And Moses stretched forth his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to his strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it; and the LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And the waters returned, and covered the chariots, and the horsemen, and all the host of Pharaoh that came into the sea after them; there remained not so much as one of them.</i></p> <p>29 <i>But the children of Israel walked upon dry land in the midst of the sea; and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And Israel saw that great work which the LORD did upon the Egyptians: and the people feared the LORD, and believed the LORD, and his servant Moses.</i></p> | <p>So Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to its normal course when the morning appeared. And as the Egyptians fled into it, the LORD threw the Egyptians into the midst of the sea.</p> <p>The waters returned and covered the chariots and the horsemen; of all the host of Pharaoh that had followed them into the sea, not one of them remained.</p> <p>But the children of Israel walked on dry ground through the sea, the waters being a wall to them on their right hand and on their left.</p> <p>Thus the LORD saved Israel that day from the hand of the Egyptians. Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore.</p> <p>Israel saw the great power that the LORD used against the Egyptians, so the people feared the LORD. They believed in the LORD and in His servant Moses.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Red sea (RED SEE) — the body of water God parted for Israel to cross on dry ground; the great act of deliverance that defines the Exodus

pillar of cloud — the visible sign of God's presence guiding Israel; by day a cloud, by night a fire

Cross-References:

v2 — Num 33:7-8; Jer 44:1

v8 — Acts 13:17; Num 33:3; Ex 6:1; Ex 14:4; Ex 13:16

v10 — Ps 107:6; Ps 34:17; Josh 24:7; Neh 9:9; Isa 51:12-13

v13 — 2 Chr 20:17; 2 Chr 20:15; Isa 41:10-14; Ex 14:30; 2 Kgs 6:16

v14 — Deut 3:22; Deut 20:4; 2 Chr 20:17; Deut 1:30; Josh 23:3

v15 — Josh 7:10; Ezra 10:4-5; Ex 17:4; Neh 9:9

v19 — Isa 63:9; Ex 32:34; Num 20:16; Ex 23:20-21

v21 — Isa 63:12; Ps 66:6; Ex 15:8; Neh 9:11; Josh 4:23

v22 — Heb 11:29; Ps 66:6; Ex 15:19; Ex 14:29; Ps 78:13

v25 — Ex 14:14; Deut 3:22; Jer 51:21; Job 20:24; 1 Sam 4:7-8

v30 — Ps 106:8; Ps 106:10

v31 — John 2:11; John 11:45; John 2:23-25; John 8:30-32

Chapter 15

Moses and the children of Israel sang a song of triumph celebrating the LORD's victory at the Red sea, praising him as a warrior who cast Pharaoh's chariots and army into the deep. Miriam led the women in singing and dancing with tambourines. The people then traveled three days into the wilderness of Shur without water; at Marah the water was bitter, but the LORD showed Moses a tree that made it sweet, and at Elim they found twelve wells and seventy palm trees.

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| <p>1 <i>Then sang Moses and the children of Israel this song unto the LORD, and spake, saying, I will sing unto the LORD, for he hath triumphed gloriously: the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.</i></p> | <p>Then Moses and the children of Israel sang this song to the LORD, saying, 'I will sing to the LORD, for He has triumphed gloriously; the horse and His rider He has thrown into the sea.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The LORD is my strength and song, and he is become my salvation: he is my God, and I will prepare him an habitation; my father's God, and I will exalt him.</i></p> | <p>The LORD is my strength and my song. He has become my salvation; this is my God. I will praise Him, my father's God. I will exalt Him.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The LORD is a man of war: the LORD is his name.</i></p> | <p>The LORD is a man of war; the LORD is His name.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Pharaoh's chariots and his host hath he cast into the sea: his chosen captains also are drowned in the Red sea.</i></p> | <p>Pharaoh's chariots and his host he cast into the sea. His chosen officers were sunk in the Red Sea.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>The depths have covered them: they sank into the bottom as a stone.</i></p> | <p>The floods covered them; they went down into the depths like a stone.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>Thy right hand, O LORD, is become glorious in power: thy right hand, O LORD, hath dashed in pieces the enemy.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And in the greatness of thine excellency thou hast overthrown them that rose up against thee: thou sentest forth thy wrath, which consumed them as stubble.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And with the blast of thy nostrils the waters were gathered together, the floods stood upright as an heap, and the depths were congealed in the heart of the sea.</i></p> <p>9 <i>The enemy said, I will pursue, I will overtake, I will divide the spoil; my lust shall be satisfied upon them; I will draw my sword, my hand shall destroy them.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Thou didst blow with thy wind, the sea covered them: they sank as lead in the mighty waters.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Who is like unto thee, O LORD, among the gods? who is like thee, glorious in holiness, fearful in praises, doing wonders?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Thou stretchedst out thy right hand, the earth swallowed them.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Thou in thy mercy hast led forth the people which thou hast redeemed: thou hast guided them in thy strength unto thy holy habitation.</i></p> | <p>Your right hand, O LORD, glorious in power, Your right hand, O LORD, shatters the enemy.</p> <p>In the greatness of Your majesty You overthrow Your adversaries; You send out Your fury; it consumes them like stubble.</p> <p>At the blast of Your nostrils the waters piled up; the floods stood up in a heap; the deeps congealed in the heart of the sea.</p> <p>The enemy said, I will pursue, I will overtake, I will divide the spoil, my desire shall have its fill of them. I will draw my sword; my hand shall destroy them.</p> <p>You blew with Your wind; the sea covered them; they sank like lead in the mighty waters.</p> <p>Who is like You, O LORD, among the gods? Who is like You, majestic in holiness, awesome in glorious deeds, doing wonders?</p> <p>You stretched out Your right hand; the earth swallowed them.</p> <p>You have led in Your mercy the people whom you have redeemed; you have guided them by Your strength to Your holy habitation.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Palestina* (pal-es-TEE-nah) — "Land of the Philistines" The coastal region of the Philistines, used poetically in the Song of Moses. Root of the later name Palestine.

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| <p>14 <i>The people shall hear, and be afraid: sorrow shall take hold on the inhabitants of Palestina.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Then the dukes of Edom shall be amazed; the mighty men of Moab, trembling shall take hold upon them; all the inhabitants of Canaan shall melt away.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Fear and dread shall fall upon them; by the greatness of thine arm they shall be as still as a stone; till thy people pass over, O LORD, till the people pass over, which thou hast purchased.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Thou shalt bring them in, and plant them in the mountain of thine inheritance, in the place, O LORD, which thou hast made for thee to dwell in, in the Sanctuary, O LORD, which thy hands have established.</i></p> <p>18 <i>The LORD shall reign for ever and ever.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For the horse of Pharaoh went in with his chariots and with his horsemen into the sea, and the LORD brought again the waters of the sea upon them; but the children of Israel went on dry land in the midst of the sea.</i></p> | <p>The peoples have heard; they tremble; pangs have seized the inhabitants of Palestina.</p> <p>Now are the chiefs of Edom dismayed; trembling seizes the leaders of Moab; all the inhabitants of Canaan have melted away.</p> <p>Terror and dread fall upon them; because of the greatness of Your arm, they are still as a stone, till Your people, O LORD, pass by, till the people pass by whom you have purchased.</p> <p>You will bring them in and plant them on Your own mountain, the place, O LORD, which You have made for Your dwelling, the sanctuary, O LORD, which Your hands have established.</p> <p>The LORD will reign forever and ever.'</p> <p>For when the horses of Pharaoh with his chariots and his horsemen went into the sea, the LORD brought back the waters of the sea upon them, but the children of Israel walked on dry ground in the midst of the sea.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Miriam* (MEER-ee-um) — "Bitter, rebellion, beloved (debated)" Older sister of Moses and Aaron. Watched over baby Moses in the Nile. Led the women in song after the Red Sea. The first prophetess named in Scripture. The name is the Hebrew form of Mary.

- 20 *And Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a timbrel in her hand; and all the women went out after her with timbrels and with dances.* Then Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a tambourine in her hand. All the women went out after her with tambourines and dancing.
- 21 *And Miriam answered them, Sing ye to the LORD, for he hath triumphed gloriously; the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.* Miriam sang to them: 'Sing to the LORD, for He has triumphed gloriously; the horse and His rider He has thrown into the sea.'

■ NAME NOTE Shur (SHOOR) — "Wall" Wilderness region just east of Egypt. First wilderness Israel entered after crossing the Red Sea.

- 22 *So Moses brought Israel from the Red sea, and they went out into the wilderness of Shur; and they went three days in the wilderness, and found no water.* Then Moses made Israel set out from the Red Sea. They went into the wilderness of Shur. They went three days in the wilderness and found no water.

■ NAME NOTE Marah (MAR-ah) — "Bitter" First water source Israel reached after the Red Sea — undrinkably bitter, which is what gave the place its name. God made it sweet through a log.

- 23 *And when they came to Marah, they could not drink of the waters of Marah, for they were bitter: therefore the name of it was called Marah.* When they came to Marah, they could not drink the water of Marah because it was bitter; therefore it was named Marah.
- 24 *And the people murmured against Moses, saying, What shall we drink?* the people grumbled against Moses, saying, 'What shall we drink?'
- 25 *And he cried unto the LORD; and the LORD shewed him a tree, which when he had cast into the waters, the waters were made sweet: there he made for them a statute and an ordinance, and there he proved them,* he cried to the LORD. The LORD showed Him a log. He threw it into the water, and the water became sweet. There the LORD made for them a statute and a rule, and there He tested them,

- 26 *And said, If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians: for I am the LORD that healeth thee.* saying, 'If You will diligently listen to the voice of the LORD Your God, and do that which is right in His eyes, and give ear to His commandments and keep all His statutes, I will put none of the diseases on You that I put on the Egyptians, for I am the LORD Your healer.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Elim (EE-lim) — "Great trees, terebinths" Oasis with twelve springs and seventy palm trees where Israel camped after Marah. A place of refreshment after the bitter water.

- 27 *And they came to Elim, where were twelve wells of water, and threescore and ten palm trees: and they encamped there by the waters.* Then they came to Elim, where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees. They encamped there by the water.

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Miriam (MEER-ee-am) — Moses and Aaron's older sister — led the women in song after the Red Sea crossing; later struck with leprosy for challenging Moses's authority.

Edom (EE-dom) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Moab (MO-ab) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rev 15:3; Ps 106:12; Ex 15:21; Isa 12:1-6; Isa 51:10-11

v2 — Isa 12:2; Ps 118:14; Ps 18:46; Ps 59:17; Isa 25:1

v3 — Ps 24:8; Ex 14:14; Rev 19:11-21; Isa 42:8; Ex 6:6-8

v6 — Ps 118:15-16; Isa 51:9; Ps 2:9; 1 Chr 29:11-12; Rev 2:27

v11 — 1 Kgs 8:23; Ps 89:5-8; 1 Sam 2:2; 2 Sam 7:22; Rev 4:8

v13 — Ps 77:20; 1 Pet 1:5; Ps 77:14-15; Ps 78:52-54; Ps 106:9

v20 — Ps 150:4; 1 Sam 18:6; Ps 149:3; Ps 68:25; Judg 11:34

v21 — Ex 15:1; Rev 7:10-12; Rev 15:3

v24 — Ex 16:2; Ex 14:11; Num 20:2-5

v25 — Deut 8:2; Ps 66:10; Judg 3:1; Judg 3:4; Judg 2:22

v26 — Ps 103:3; Deut 7:15; Ex 23:25; Ps 41:3-4; Ps 147:3
v27 — Rev 22:2; Rev 7:17; Num 33:9; Isa 12:3; Ezek 47:12

Chapter 16

The whole congregation murmured against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness of Sin, wishing they had died in Egypt where they had bread to eat. The LORD sent quail in the evening and manna from heaven each morning — a small, round, white substance tasting like wafers with honey — commanding them to gather a daily portion but double on the sixth day, for the seventh day was a Sabbath rest. Some disobeyed and it bred worms; others went out on the Sabbath and found nothing; Israel ate manna for forty years until they reached Canaan.

■ **NAME NOTE** Sin (SIN) — "Clay, mire" Wilderness region between Elim and Sinai. Unrelated to the English word for moral transgression — this is the Hebrew place-name. Where manna first fell. Sinai (SY-nye) — "Thorny, or "of Sin (the moon god)" — disputed" The sacred mountain where Moses received the Law. Also called Horeb. Site of the burning bush, the Ten Commandments, and the tabernacle instructions.

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And they took their journey from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came unto the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt.

They set out from Elim. All the congregation of the children of Israel came to the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after they had departed from the land of Egypt.
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And the whole congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness:

the whole congregation of the children of Israel grumbled against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness.
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And the children of Israel said unto them, Would to God we had died by the hand of the LORD in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the flesh pots, and when we did eat bread to the full; for ye have brought us forth into this wilderness, to kill this whole assembly with hunger.

The children of Israel said to them, 'Would that we had died by the hand of the LORD in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the meat pots and ate bread to the full, for You have brought us out into this wilderness to kill this whole assembly with hunger.'

- 4 *Then said the LORD unto Moses, Behold, I will rain bread from heaven for you; and the people shall go out and gather a certain rate every day, that I may prove them, whether they will walk in my law, or no.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'I am about to rain bread from heaven for you, and the people shall go out and gather a day's portion every day, that I may test them, whether they will walk in my law or not.
- 5 *And it shall come to pass, that on the sixth day they shall prepare that which they bring in; and it shall be twice as much as they gather daily.* On the sixth day, when they prepare what they bring in, it will be twice as much as they gather daily.'
- 6 *And Moses and Aaron said unto all the children of Israel, At even, then ye shall know that the LORD hath brought you out from the land of Egypt:* So Moses and Aaron said to all the children of Israel, 'At evening You shall know that it was the LORD Who brought You out of the land of Egypt,
- 7 *And in the morning, then ye shall see the glory of the LORD; for that he heareth your murmurings against the LORD: and what are we, that ye murmur against us?* in the morning You shall see the glory of the LORD, because He has heard Your grumbling against the LORD. For what are we, that You grumble against us?'
- 8 *And Moses said, This shall be, when the LORD shall give you in the evening flesh to eat, and in the morning bread to the full; for that the LORD heareth your murmurings which ye murmur against him: and what are we? your murmurings are not against us, but against the LORD.* Moses said, 'When the LORD gives You in the evening meat to eat and in the morning bread to the full, because the LORD has heard Your grumbling that You grumble against Him — what are we? Your grumbling is not against us but against the LORD.'
- 9 *And Moses spake unto Aaron, Say unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, Come near before the LORD: for he hath heard your murmurings.* Then Moses said to Aaron, 'Say to the whole congregation of the children of Israel, Come near before the LORD, for he has heard your grumbling.'

- 10 *And it came to pass, as Aaron spake unto the whole congregation of the children of Israel, that they looked toward the wilderness, and, behold, the glory of the LORD appeared in the cloud.* as soon as Aaron spoke to the whole congregation of the children of Israel, they looked toward the wilderness, and the glory of the LORD appeared in the cloud.
- 11 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD said to Moses,
- 12 *I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel: speak unto them, saying, At even ye shall eat flesh, and in the morning ye shall be filled with bread; and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God.* 'I have heard the grumbling of the children of Israel. Say to them, At twilight You shall eat meat, and in the morning You shall be filled with bread. Then You shall know that I am the LORD Your God.'
- 13 *And it came to pass, that at even the quails came up, and covered the camp: and in the morning the dew lay round about the host.* In the evening quail came up and covered the camp, and in the morning dew lay around the camp.
- 14 *And when the dew that lay was gone up, behold, upon the face of the wilderness there lay a small round thing, as small as the hoar frost on the ground.* when the dew had gone up, there was on the face of the wilderness a fine, flake-like thing, fine as frost on the ground.
- 15 *And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another, It is manna: for they wist not what it was. And Moses said unto them, This is the bread which the LORD hath given you to eat.* When the children of Israel saw it, they said to one another, 'What is it?' For they did not know what it was. And Moses said to them, 'It is the bread that the LORD has given You to eat.'
- 16 *This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded, Gather of it every man according to his eating, an omer for every man, according to the number of your persons; take ye every man for them which are in his tents.* This is what the LORD has commanded: Gather of it, each one of you, as much as he can eat. You shall each take an omer, according to the number of the persons that each of You has in his tent.'

- 17 *And the children of Israel did so, and gathered, some more, some less.* the children of Israel did so. They gathered, some more, some less.
- 18 *And when they did mete it with an omer, he that gathered much had nothing over, and he that gathered little had no lack; they gathered every man according to his eating.* But when they measured it with an omer, whoever gathered much had nothing left over, and whoever gathered little had no lack. Each gathered as much as He could eat.
- 19 *And Moses said, Let no man leave of it till the morning.* Moses said to them, 'Let no one leave any of it till the morning.'
- 20 *Notwithstanding they hearkened not unto Moses; but some of them left of it until the morning, and it bred worms, and stank: and Moses was wroth with them.* But they did not listen to Moses. Some left part of it till the morning. It bred worms and stank. And Moses was angry with them.
- 21 *And they gathered it every morning, every man according to his eating: and when the sun waxed hot, it melted.* Morning by morning they gathered it, each as much as he could eat; but when the sun grew hot, it melted.
- 22 *And it came to pass, that on the sixth day they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for one man: and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses.* On the sixth day they gathered twice as much bread, two omers each. And when all the leaders of the congregation came and told Moses,
- 23 *And he said unto them, This is that which the LORD hath said, To morrow is the rest of the holy sabbath unto the LORD: bake that which ye will bake to day, and seethe that ye will seethe; and that which remaineth over lay up for you to be kept until the morning.* he said to them, 'This is what the LORD has commanded: Tomorrow is a day of solemn rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD; bake what You will bake and boil what You will boil. All that is left over lay aside to be kept till the morning.'
- 24 *And they laid it up till the morning, as Moses bade: and it did not stink, neither was there any worm therein.* So they laid it aside till the morning, as Moses commanded them. It did not stink, and there were no worms in it.

- 25 *And Moses said, Eat that to day; for to day is a sabbath unto the LORD: to day ye shall not find it in the field.* Moses said, 'Eat it today, for today is a Sabbath to the LORD; today You will not find it in the field.
- 26 *Six days ye shall gather it; but on the seventh day, which is the sabbath, in it there shall be none.* Six days You shall gather it, but on the seventh day, which is a Sabbath, there will be none.'
- 27 *And it came to pass, that there went out some of the people on the seventh day for to gather, and they found none.* On the seventh day some of the people went out to gather. But They found none.
- 28 *And the LORD said unto Moses, How long refuse ye to keep my commandments and my laws?* the LORD said to Moses, 'How long will you refuse to keep my commandments and my laws?
- 29 *See, for that the LORD hath given you the sabbath, therefore he giveth you on the sixth day the bread of two days; abide ye every man in his place, let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.* See, the LORD has given You the Sabbath; therefore on the sixth day He gives You bread for two days. Remain each of You in His place; let no one go out of his place on the seventh day.'
- 30 *So the people rested on the seventh day.* So the people rested on the seventh day.

■ **NAME NOTE** *Manna (MAN-uh) — "What is it?" The bread from heaven God gave Israel for 40 years in the wilderness. The name comes from the question the Israelites asked when they first saw it.*

- 31 *And the house of Israel called the name thereof Manna: and it was like coriander seed, white; and the taste of it was like wafers made with honey.* Now the house of Israel called its name manna. It was like coriander seed, white, and the taste of it was like wafers made with honey.

- 32 *And Moses said, This is the thing which the LORD commandeth, Fill an omer of it to be kept for your generations; that they may see the bread wherewith I have fed you in the wilderness, when I brought you forth from the land of Egypt.* Moses said, 'This is what the LORD has commanded: Let an omerful of it be kept throughout Your generations, so that they may see the bread with which I fed You in the wilderness, when I brought You out of the land of Egypt.'
- 33 *And Moses said unto Aaron, Take a pot, and put an omer full of manna therein, and lay it up before the LORD, to be kept for your generations.* Moses said to Aaron, 'Take a jar, and put an omer of manna in it, and place it before the LORD to be kept throughout your generations.'
- 34 *As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to be kept.* As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron placed it before the Testimony to be kept.
- 35 *And the children of Israel did eat manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited; they did eat manna, until they came unto the borders of the land of Canaan.* The children of Israel ate the manna forty years, till they came to a habitable land. They ate the manna till they came to the border of the land of Canaan.
- 36 *Now an omer is the tenth part of an ephah.* (An omer is the tenth part of an ephah.)

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Sinai (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 15:24; 1 Cor 10:10

v3 — Num 11:4-5; Num 20:3-5; Ex 17:3; Lam 4:9; Deut 28:67

v7 — Isa 40:5; Num 16:11; John 11:40; Ex 16:10; John 11:4

v8 — Rom 13:2; 1 Sam 8:7

v13 — Num 11:9; Ps 78:27-28; Ps 105:40

- v15 — Ex 16:4; Ex 16:31; John 6:58; John 6:31-32; Deut 8:3
- v18 — 2 Cor 8:14-15
- v19 — Ex 23:18; Ex 12:10
- v23 — Lev 23:3; Ex 20:8-11; Ex 31:15
- v29 — Isa 58:13-14; Ex 31:13
- v34 — Ex 27:21; Ex 25:16; Ex 25:21
- v35 — Neh 9:20-21; Josh 5:12; Deut 8:2-3

Chapter 17

At Rephidim the people quarreled with Moses because there was no water; the LORD told Moses to strike the rock at Horeb with his staff, and water came out. Amalek then attacked Israel, and Joshua led the fight while Moses held up the staff of God on the hilltop — when his hands grew weary, Aaron and Hur held them up until sunset, and Israel prevailed. The LORD declared that he would have war with Amalek from generation to generation.

■ **NAME NOTE** Rephidim (REF-ih-dim) — "Resting places" Israel's camp near Sinai where Moses struck the rock for water, and where Israel fought its first battle against Amalek.

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| 1 <i>And all the congregation of the children of Israel journeyed from the wilderness of Sin, after their journeys, according to the commandment of the LORD, and pitched in Rephidim: and there was no water for the people to drink.</i> | All the congregation of the children of Israel moved on from the wilderness of Sin by stages, according to the commandment of the LORD, and camped at Rephidim, but there was no water for the people to drink. |
| 2 <i>Wherefore the people did chide with Moses, and said, Give us water that we may drink. And Moses said unto them, Why chide ye with me? wherefore do ye tempt the LORD?</i> | Therefore the people quarreled with Moses and said, 'Give us water to drink.' And Moses said to them, 'Why do you quarrel with me? Why do You tempt the LORD?' |
| 3 <i>And the people thirsted there for water; and the people murmured against Moses, and said, Wherefore is this that thou hast brought us up out of Egypt, to kill us and our children and our cattle with thirst?</i> | But the people thirsted there for water, and the people grumbled against Moses and said, 'Why did you bring us up out of Egypt, to kill us and our children and our livestock with thirst?' |

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| <p>4 <i>And Moses cried unto the LORD, saying, What shall I do unto this people? they be almost ready to stone me.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Go on before the people, and take with thee of the elders of Israel; and thy rod, wherewith thou smotest the river, take in thine hand, and go.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Behold, I will stand before thee there upon the rock in Horeb; and thou shalt smite the rock, and there shall come water out of it, that the people may drink. And Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel.</i></p> | <p>So Moses cried to the LORD, 'What shall I do with this people? They are almost ready to stone me.'</p> <p>the LORD said to Moses, 'Pass on before the people, taking with you some of the elders of Israel, and take in your hand the staff with which you struck the Nile, and go.</p> <p>I will stand before you there on the rock at Horeb, and you shall strike the rock, and water shall come out of it, and the people will drink.' And Moses did so, in the sight of the elders of Israel.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Massah (MAS-uh) — "Testing, trial" Name given to the place where Israel tested the LORD, demanding water. Later referenced in Psalm 95 as a warning. Meribah (MER-ih-bah) — "Quarreling, strife" Paired name with Massah for the same event. Israel quarreled with Moses, and Moses quarreled with them for testing God.

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| <p>7 <i>And he called the name of the place Massah, and Meribah, because of the chiding of the children of Israel, and because they tempted the LORD, saying, Is the LORD among us, or not?</i></p> <p>8 <i>Then came Amalek, and fought with Israel in Rephidim.</i></p> | <p>he called the name of the place Massah and Meribah, because of the quarreling of the children of Israel, and because they tempted the LORD by saying, 'Is the LORD among us or not?'</p> <p>Then Amalek came and fought with Israel at Rephidim.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Joshua (JOSH-oo-uh) — "The LORD is salvation" Son of Nun from the tribe of Ephraim. Moses's assistant and military commander. Leads Israel's first battle here against Amalek. Later succeeds Moses and leads Israel into the Promised Land. The Hebrew form of the name is Yeshua — the same name as Jesus.

- 9 *And Moses said unto Joshua, Choose us out men, and go out, fight with Amalek: to morrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in mine hand.* So Moses said to Joshua, 'Choose for us men, and go out and fight with Amalek. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the staff of God in my hand.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Hur (HUR) — "Noble, cave, whiteness" One of Israel's leaders, associate of Moses and Aaron. Held up Moses's hands during the battle with Amalek. Later left in charge with Aaron when Moses went up Sinai.

- 10 *So Joshua did as Moses had said to him, and fought with Amalek: and Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill.* So Joshua did as Moses told him, and fought with Amalek, while Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed: and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed.* Whenever Moses held up his hand, Israel prevailed, and whenever he lowered his hand, Amalek prevailed.
- 12 *But Moses' hands were heavy; and they took a stone, and put it under him, and he sat thereon; and Aaron and Hur stayed up his hands, the one on the one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun.* But Moses' hands grew weary, so they took a stone and put it under him. He sat on it, while Aaron and Hur held up his hands, one on one side, and the other on the other side. So his hands were steady until the going down of the sun.
- 13 *And Joshua discomfited Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword.* Joshua overwhelmed Amalek and his people with the sword.
- 14 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Write this for a memorial in a book, and rehearse it in the ears of Joshua: for I will utterly put out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Write this as a memorial in a book and recite it in the ears of Joshua, that I will utterly blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven.'

■ **NAME NOTE** Jehovahnissi (jeh-HO-vah-NIS-sigh) — "The LORD is my banner" Name Moses gave to the altar after defeating Amalek. Declared war between the LORD and Amalek from generation to generation.

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| <p>15 <i>And Moses built an altar, and called the name of it Jehovahnissi:</i></p> <p>16 <i>For he said, Because the LORD hath sworn that the LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.</i></p> | <p>Moses built an altar and called the name of it Jehovahnissi,</p> <p>saying, 'A hand upon the throne of the LORD! The LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Horeb (*HOR-eb*) — Another name for Mount Sinai — the mountain where God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and later where Elijah fled from Jezebel.

Jehovahnissi (*jeh-HO-vah-NIS-ee*) — Hebrew name meaning 'The LORD is my banner' — the name Moses gave to the altar after Israel's victory over Amalek.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 78:18; 1 Cor 10:9; Ps 78:41; Deut 6:16; Heb 3:9
- v3 — Ex 16:2-3
- v4 — 1 Sam 30:6; Num 14:10
- v5 — Ex 7:19-20; Num 20:8-11
- v6 — 1 Cor 10:4; Num 20:9-11; Neh 9:15; Ps 105:41; Deut 8:15
- v7 — Ps 81:7; Num 20:13; Ps 95:8; Deut 9:22
- v8 — Deut 25:17-19; Gen 36:12; 1 Sam 30:1; Num 24:20; 1 Sam 15:2
- v9 — Ex 24:13; Ex 4:20; Deut 32:44; Ex 4:2
- v11 — 1 Tim 2:8; Jas 5:16; Luke 18:1; Ps 56:9
- v12 — Isa 35:3; Phil 1:19; Heb 12:12; Eph 6:18; Mark 14:37-40
- v14 — Ex 34:27; 1 Sam 30:1; 1 Sam 30:17; Num 24:20
- v15 — Gen 22:14; Judg 6:24; Ps 60:4

Chapter 18

Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, brought Zipporah and Moses' two sons to him in the wilderness, rejoiced at all the LORD had done for Israel, and offered sacrifices to God. Seeing Moses judge the people alone from morning to evening, Jethro counseled him to appoint able men as rulers of thousands, hundreds, fifties, and tens to handle lesser matters. Moses listened to Jethro's advice and set up the system of delegated judges.

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| <p>1 <i>When Jethro, the priest of Midian, Moses' father in law, heard of all that God had done for Moses, and for Israel his people, and that the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt;</i></p> <p>2 <i>Then Jethro, Moses' father in law, took Zipporah, Moses' wife, after he had sent her back,</i></p> <p>3 <i>And her two sons; of which the name of the one was Gershom; for he said, I have been an alien in a strange land:</i></p> | <p>Jethro, the priest of Midian, Moses' father-in-law, heard of all that God had done for Moses and for Israel his people, how the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt.</p> <p>Now Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, had taken Zipporah, Moses' wife, after he had sent her home,</p> <p>along with her two sons. The name of the one was Gershom (for he said, 'I have been a sojourner in a foreign land'),</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Eliezer (el-ih-EE-zer)* — "God is help" Moses's second son by Zipporah. Named for God's deliverance from Pharaoh's sword. (A different Eliezer was Abraham's steward in Genesis 15.)

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| <p>4 <i>And the name of the other was Eliezer; for the God of my father, said he, was mine help, and delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh:</i></p> <p>5 <i>And Jethro, Moses' father in law, came with his sons and his wife unto Moses into the wilderness, where he encamped at the mount of God:</i></p> <p>6 <i>And he said unto Moses, I thy father in law Jethro am come unto thee, and thy wife, and her two sons with her.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And Moses went out to meet his father in law, and did obeisance, and kissed him; and they asked each other of their welfare; and they came into the tent.</i></p> | <p>the name of the other, Eliezer (for he said, 'The God of my father was my help, and delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh').</p> <p>Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, came with his sons and his wife to Moses in the wilderness where he was encamped at the mountain of God.</p> <p>he sent word to Moses, 'I, your father-in-law Jethro, am coming to you with your wife and her two sons with her.'</p> <p>Moses went out to meet his father-in-law and bowed down and kissed him. And they asked each other of their welfare and went into the tent.</p> |
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- 8 *And Moses told his father in law all that the LORD had done unto Pharaoh and to the Egyptians for Israel's sake, and all the travail that had come upon them by the way, and how the LORD delivered them.* Then Moses told his father-in-law all that the LORD had done to Pharaoh and to the Egyptians for Israel's sake, all the hardship that had come upon them in the way, and how the LORD had delivered them.
- 9 *And Jethro rejoiced for all the goodness which the LORD had done to Israel, whom he had delivered out of the hand of the Egyptians.* Jethro rejoiced for all the good that the LORD had done to Israel, in that He had delivered them out of the hand of the Egyptians.
- 10 *And Jethro said, Blessed be the LORD, who hath delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of Pharaoh, who hath delivered the people from under the hand of the Egyptians.* Jethro said, 'Blessed be the LORD, Who has delivered You out of the hand of the Egyptians and out of the hand of Pharaoh and has delivered the people from under the hand of the Egyptians.
- 11 *Now I know that the LORD is greater than all gods: for in the thing wherein they dealt proudly he was above them.* Now I know that the LORD is greater than all gods, because in this affair they dealt arrogantly with the people.'
- 12 *And Jethro, Moses' father in law, took a burnt offering and sacrifices for God: and Aaron came, and all the elders of Israel, to eat bread with Moses' father in law before God.* Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, brought a burnt offering and sacrifices to God. Aaron came with all the elders of Israel to eat bread with Moses' father-in-law before God.
- 13 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses sat to judge the people: and the people stood by Moses from the morning unto the evening.* The next day Moses sat to judge the people, and the people stood around Moses from morning till evening.
- 14 *And when Moses' father in law saw all that he did to the people, he said, What is this thing that thou doest to the people? why sittest thou thyself alone, and all the people stand by thee from morning unto even?* When Moses' father-in-law saw all that he was doing for the people, he said, 'What is this that you are doing for the people? Why do you sit alone, while all the people stand around you from morning till evening?'

- 15 *And Moses said unto his father in law, Because the people come unto me to enquire of God:* Moses said to his father-in-law, 'Because the people come to me to inquire of God;
- 16 *When they have a matter, they come unto me; and I judge between one and another, and I do make them know the statutes of God, and his laws.* when they have a dispute, they come to me and I decide between one person and another. I make them know the statutes of God and His laws.'
- 17 *And Moses' father in law said unto him, The thing that thou doest is not good.* Moses' father-in-law said to him, 'What you are doing is not good.
- 18 *Thou wilt surely wear away, both thou, and this people that is with thee: for this thing is too heavy for thee; thou art not able to perform it thyself alone.* You and the people with you will certainly wear yourselves out, for the thing is too heavy for you. You are not able to do it alone.
- 19 *Hearken now unto my voice, I will give thee counsel, and God shall be with thee: Be thou for the people to God-ward, that thou mayest bring the causes unto God:* Now obey my voice; I will give you advice. God be with you! You shall represent the people before God and bring their cases to God,
- 20 *And thou shalt teach them ordinances and laws, and shalt shew them the way wherein they must walk, and the work that they must do.* you shall warn them about the statutes and the laws, and make them know the way in which they must walk and what they must do.
- 21 *Moreover thou shalt provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, men of truth, hating covetousness; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, and rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens:* Moreover, look for able men from all the people, men who fear God, men of truth, who hate dishonest gain, and place such men over the people as chiefs of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens.

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| 22 <i>And let them judge the people at all seasons: and it shall be, that every great matter they shall bring unto thee, but every small matter they shall judge: so shall it be easier for thyself, and they shall bear the burden with thee.</i> | let them judge the people at all times. Every great matter they shall bring to you, but any small matter they shall decide themselves. So it will be easier for you. They will bear the burden with you. |
| 23 <i>If thou shalt do this thing, and God command thee so, then thou shalt be able to endure, and all this people shall also go to their place in peace.</i> | If you do this, God so commanding you, then you will be able to endure. All this people also will go to their place in peace.' |
| 24 <i>So Moses hearkened to the voice of his father in law, and did all that he had said.</i> | So Moses listened to the voice of his father-in-law and did all that he had said. |
| 25 <i>And Moses chose able men out of all Israel, and made them heads over the people, rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens.</i> | Moses chose able men out of all Israel and made them heads over the people, chiefs of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens. |
| 26 <i>And they judged the people at all seasons: the hard causes they brought unto Moses, but every small matter they judged themselves.</i> | they judged the people at all times. Any hard case they brought to Moses, but any small matter they decided themselves. |
| 27 <i>And Moses let his father in law depart; and he went his way into his own land.</i> | Then Moses let his father-in-law depart. He went away to his own country. |

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 2:16; Ex 3:1; Ps 77:14-15

v3 — Ex 2:22; Acts 7:29

v5 — Ex 3:1

v7 — Gen 29:13

v11 — Ps 95:3; Ex 15:11; 2 Chr 2:5; Ps 135:5; Luke 1:51

v18 — Num 11:14-17; Acts 6:1-4

v19 — Num 27:5

v20 — Deut 5:1; Ps 143:8; Deut 1:18

v21 — Acts 6:3; Deut 1:13-17; 2 Chr 19:5-10; Deut 16:18-19

v22 — Num 11:17

v25 — Deut 1:15

v26 — Ex 18:22

Chapter 19

Israel camped before Mount Sinai, and the LORD told Moses that if the people obeyed his voice and kept his covenant they would be a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. The people consecrated themselves for three days, washing their clothes and setting bounds around the mountain. On the third day the LORD descended on Sinai in fire with thunder, lightning, a thick cloud, and the sound of a trumpet so loud that the people trembled.

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| 1 | <i>In the third month, when the children of Israel were gone forth out of the land of Egypt, the same day came they into the wilderness of Sinai.</i> | On the third new moon after the children of Israel had gone out of the land of Egypt, on that day they came into the wilderness of Sinai. |
| 2 | <i>For they were departed from Rephidim, and were come to the desert of Sinai, and had pitched in the wilderness; and there Israel camped before the mount.</i> | They set out from Rephidim and came into the wilderness of Sinai. They encamped in the wilderness. There Israel encamped before the mountain, |
| 3 | <i>And Moses went up unto God, and the LORD called unto him out of the mountain, saying, Thus shalt thou say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel;</i> | while Moses went up to God. The LORD called to Him out of the mountain, saying, 'Thus You shall say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel: |
| 4 | <i>Ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagles' wings, and brought you unto myself.</i> | You yourselves have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore You on eagles' wings and brought You to myself. |

- 5 *Now therefore, if ye will obey my voice indeed, and keep my covenant, then ye shall be a peculiar treasure unto me above all people: for all the earth is mine:* Now therefore, if You will indeed obey my voice and keep my covenant, You shall be my treasured possession among all peoples, for all the earth is mine;
- 6 *And ye shall be unto me a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation. These are the words which thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel.* you shall be to me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. These are the words that You shall speak to the children of Israel.'
- 7 *And Moses came and called for the elders of the people, and laid before their faces all these words which the LORD commanded him.* So Moses came and called the elders of the people and set before them all these words that the LORD had commanded Him.
- 8 *And all the people answered together, and said, All that the LORD hath spoken we will do. And Moses returned the words of the people unto the LORD.* All the people answered together and said, 'All that the LORD has spoken we will do.' And Moses reported the words of the people to the LORD.
- 9 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Lo, I come unto thee in a thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with thee, and believe thee for ever. And Moses told the words of the people unto the LORD.* the LORD said to Moses, 'I am coming to you in a thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with you, and may also believe You forever.' When Moses told the words of the people to the LORD,
- 10 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Go unto the people, and sanctify them to day and to morrow, and let them wash their clothes,* the LORD said to Moses, 'Go to the people and consecrate them today and tomorrow, and let them wash their garments
- 11 *And be ready against the third day: for the third day the LORD will come down in the sight of all the people upon mount Sinai.* be ready for the third day. For on the third day the LORD will come down on Mount Sinai in the sight of all the people.

- 12 *And thou shalt set bounds unto the people round about, saying, Take heed to yourselves, that ye go not up into the mount, or touch the border of it: whosoever toucheth the mount shall be surely put to death:* you shall set limits for the people all around, saying, Take care not to go up into the mountain or touch the edge of it. Whoever touches the mountain shall be put to death.
- 13 *There shall not an hand touch it, but he shall surely be stoned, or shot through; whether it be beast or man, it shall not live: when the trumpet soundeth long, they shall come up to the mount.* No hand shall touch Him, but He shall be stoned or shot; whether beast or man, He shall not live. When the trumpet sounds a long blast, they shall come up to the mountain.'
- 14 *And Moses went down from the mount unto the people, and sanctified the people; and they washed their clothes.* So Moses went down from the mountain to the people and consecrated the people. They washed their garments.
- 15 *And he said unto the people, Be ready against the third day: come not at your wives.* he said to the people, 'Be ready for the third day; do not go near a woman.'
- 16 *And it came to pass on the third day in the morning, that there were thunders and lightnings, and a thick cloud upon the mount, and the voice of the trumpet exceeding loud; so that all the people that was in the camp trembled.* On the morning of the third day there were thunders and lightnings and a thick cloud on the mountain and a very loud trumpet blast, so that all the people in the camp trembled.
- 17 *And Moses brought forth the people out of the camp to meet with God; and they stood at the nether part of the mount.* Then Moses brought the people out of the camp to meet God. They took their stand at the foot of the mountain.
- 18 *And mount Sinai was altogether on a smoke, because the LORD descended upon it in fire: and the smoke thereof ascended as the smoke of a furnace, and the whole mount quaked greatly.* Now Mount Sinai was wrapped in smoke because the LORD had descended on it in fire. The smoke of it went up like the smoke of a kiln, and the whole mountain trembled greatly.

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| 19 | <i>And when the voice of the trumpet sounded long, and waxed louder and louder, Moses spake, and God answered him by a voice.</i> | as the sound of the trumpet grew louder and louder, Moses spoke. God answered Him in thunder. |
| 20 | <i>And the LORD came down upon mount Sinai, on the top of the mount: and the LORD called Moses up to the top of the mount; and Moses went up.</i> | The LORD came down on Mount Sinai, to the top of the mountain. And the LORD called Moses to the top of the mountain, and Moses went up. |
| 21 | <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Go down, charge the people, lest they break through unto the LORD to gaze, and many of them perish.</i> | the LORD said to Moses, 'Go down and warn the people, lest they break through to the LORD to look and many of them perish. |
| 22 | <i>And let the priests also, which come near to the LORD, sanctify themselves, lest the LORD break forth upon them.</i> | Also let the priests who come near to the LORD consecrate themselves, lest the LORD break out against them.' |
| 23 | <i>And Moses said unto the LORD, The people cannot come up to mount Sinai: for thou chargedst us, saying, Set bounds about the mount, and sanctify it.</i> | Moses said to the LORD, 'The people cannot come up to Mount Sinai, for you yourself warned us, saying, Set limits around the mountain and consecrate it.' |
| 24 | <i>And the LORD said unto him, Away, get thee down, and thou shalt come up, thou, and Aaron with thee: but let not the priests and the people break through to come up unto the LORD, lest he break forth upon them.</i> | the LORD said to Him, 'Go down, and come up bringing Aaron with you. But do not let the priests and the people break through to come up to the LORD, lest He break out against them.' |
| 25 | <i>So Moses went down unto the people, and spake unto them.</i> | So Moses went down to the people and told them. |

Words in this chapter:

Jacob (JAY-kub) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Sinai (SY-ny) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ex 3:1; Ex 17:1
- v3 — Ex 3:4
- v4 — Deut 32:11-12; Isa 63:9; Isa 40:31; Deut 29:2; Rev 12:14
- v5 — Deut 14:2; Deut 7:6; Deut 26:18; Mal 3:17; Ex 15:26
- v6 — Rev 5:10; 1 Pet 2:9; 1 Pet 2:5; Deut 7:6; Rev 1:6
- v8 — Ex 24:7; Ex 24:3; Josh 24:24
- v9 — Deut 4:36; Ex 19:16; Ex 24:15-16
- v10 — Heb 10:22; Lev 11:44-45; Gen 35:2; Lev 11:25; Num 8:21
- v12 — Heb 12:20-21
- v16 — Heb 12:18-19; Ps 18:11-14; Heb 12:21; Rev 4:1; Rev 4:5
- v18 — Judg 5:5; Ps 144:5; Ex 3:2; Rev 15:8
- v21 — 1 Sam 6:19

Chapter 20

God spoke the Ten Commandments from Mount Sinai: no other gods, no graven images, do not take the LORD's name in vain, keep the Sabbath, honor father and mother, do not kill, do not commit adultery, do not steal, do not bear false witness, do not covet. The people stood far off, trembling at the thunder and fire, and begged Moses to speak to them instead of God. The LORD gave instructions for building altars of earth or uncut stone, forbidding steps that would expose nakedness.

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| 1 | <i>And God spake all these words, saying,</i> | God spoke all these words, saying, |
| 2 | <i>I am the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.</i> | 'I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. |
| 3 | <i>Thou shalt have no other gods before me.</i> | You shall have no other gods before me. |
| 4 | <i>Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth:</i> | You shall not make for Yourself a carved image, or any likeness of anything that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth. |

- 5 *Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them: for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me;* You shall not bow down to them or serve them, for I the LORD Your God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children to the third and the fourth generation of those who hate me,
- 6 *And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments.* but showing mercy to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments.
- 7 *Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain; for the LORD will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.* You shall not take the name of the LORD Your God in vain, for the LORD will not hold Him guiltless who takes His name in vain.
- 8 *Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy.* Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy.
- 9 *Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work:* Six days You shall labor, and do all Your work,
- 10 *But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates:* but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD Your God. On it You shall not do any work, You, or Your son, or Your daughter, Your male servant, or Your female servant, or Your livestock, or the sojourner who is within Your gates.
- 11 *For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.* For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, and rested on the seventh day. Therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day and made it holy.
- 12 *Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.* Honor Your father and Your mother, that Your days may be long in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You.
- 13 *Thou shalt not kill.* You shall not kill.

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| 14 | <i>Thou shalt not commit adultery.</i> | You shall not commit adultery. |
| 15 | <i>Thou shalt not steal.</i> | You shall not steal. |
| 16 | <i>Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.</i> | You shall not bear false witness against Your neighbor. |
| 17 | <i>Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.</i> | You shall not covet Your neighbor's house; You shall not covet Your neighbor's wife, or His male servant, or His female servant, or His ox, or his donkey, or anything that is Your neighbor's.' |
| 18 | <i>And all the people saw the thunderings, and the lightnings, and the noise of the trumpet, and the mountain smoking; and when the people saw it, they removed, and stood afar off.</i> | Now when all the people saw the thunder and the flashes of lightning and the sound of the trumpet and the mountain smoking, the people were afraid and trembled. They stood far off |
| 19 | <i>And they said unto Moses, Speak thou with us, and we will hear: but let not God speak with us, lest we die.</i> | said to Moses, 'You speak to us. We will listen; but do not let God speak to us, lest we die.' |
| 20 | <i>And Moses said unto the people, Fear not: for God is come to prove you, and that his fear may be before your faces, that ye sin not.</i> | Moses said to the people, 'Do not fear, for God has come to test you, that the fear of him may be before you, that you may not sin.' |
| 21 | <i>And the people stood afar off, and Moses drew near unto the thick darkness where God was.</i> | The people stood far off, while Moses drew near to the thick darkness where God was. |
| 22 | <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Thus thou shalt say unto the children of Israel, Ye have seen that I have talked with you from heaven.</i> | the LORD said to Moses, 'Thus you shall say to the children of Israel: you have seen for yourselves that I have talked with you from heaven. |
| 23 | <i>Ye shall not make with me gods of silver, neither shall ye make unto you gods of gold.</i> | You shall not make gods of silver to be with me, nor shall You make for yourselves gods of gold. |

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| <p>24 <i>An altar of earth thou shalt make unto me, and shalt sacrifice thereon thy burnt offerings, and thy peace offerings, thy sheep, and thine oxen: in all places where I record my name I will come unto thee, and I will bless thee.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And if thou wilt make me an altar of stone, thou shalt not build it of hewn stone: for if thou lift up thy tool upon it, thou hast polluted it.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Neither shalt thou go up by steps unto mine altar, that thy nakedness be not discovered thereon.</i></p> | <p>An altar of earth You shall make for me and sacrifice on it Your burnt offerings and Your peace offerings, Your sheep and Your oxen. In every place where I cause my name to be remembered I will come to You and bless You.</p> <p>If You make me an altar of stone, You shall not build it of hewn stones, for if You wield Your tool on it You profane it.</p> <p>you shall not go up by steps to my altar, that Your nakedness be not exposed on it.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 5:6; Hos 13:4; Ps 81:10; Lev 26:13; Ex 13:3
- v3 — Deut 5:7; Matt 4:10; Ps 81:9; Isa 46:9; Deut 6:5
- v4 — Deut 5:8; Lev 26:1; Deut 4:15-19; Ps 97:7; Lev 19:4
- v5 — Deut 5:9; Num 14:18; Deut 4:24; Ex 34:14; Josh 24:19
- v7 — Deut 5:11; Lev 19:12; Jas 5:12; Matt 5:33-37; Ps 50:14-16
- v8 — Lev 26:2; Lev 19:3; Gen 2:3; Ex 31:13-16; Lev 23:3
- v12 — Eph 6:1-3; Col 3:20; Deut 5:16; Mark 7:10; Prov 23:22-25
- v13 — Rom 13:9; Deut 5:17; Gen 9:5-6; Ex 21:14; Matt 5:21-22
- v14 — Heb 13:4; Deut 5:18; Rom 7:2-3; Rom 13:9; Rev 21:8
- v15 — Rom 13:9; Eph 4:28; Lev 19:11; Lev 19:13; Matt 19:18
- v17 — Rom 13:9; Luke 12:15; Heb 13:5; Eph 5:5; Eph 5:3
- v24 — Deut 12:5; Ps 132:13-14; 2 Chr 6:6; 1 Kgs 9:3; 2 Chr 7:16

Chapter 21

The LORD gave laws governing Hebrew servants — including their release in the seventh year and the rights of a maidservant — and laws regarding violence: the penalty for murder, striking or cursing a parent, and kidnapping was death. The principle of "eye for eye, tooth for tooth" governed bodily injuries, and laws addressed injuries caused by an ox that gored a

person to death.

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| <p>1 Now these are the judgments which thou shalt set before them.</p> | 'Now these are the rules that You shall set before them. |
| <p>2 If thou buy an Hebrew servant, six years he shall serve: and in the seventh he shall go out free for nothing.</p> | When You buy a Hebrew servant, He shall serve six years, and in the seventh He shall go out free, for nothing. |
| <p>3 If he came in by himself, he shall go out by himself: if he were married, then his wife shall go out with him.</p> | If He comes in single, He shall go out single; if He comes in married, then his wife shall go out with Him. |
| <p>4 If his master have given him a wife, and she have born him sons or daughters; the wife and her children shall be her master's, and he shall go out by himself.</p> | If His master gives Him a wife and she bears Him sons or daughters, the wife and her children shall be her master's. He shall go out alone. |
| <p>5 And if the servant shall plainly say, I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go out free:</p> | But if the servant plainly says, I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go out free, |
| <p>6 Then his master shall bring him unto the judges; he shall also bring him to the door, or unto the door post; and his master shall bore his ear through with an aul; and he shall serve him for ever.</p> | then His master shall bring Him to the judges. He shall also bring Him to the door or the doorpost. His master shall pierce His ear through with an awl. He shall serve Him forever. |
| <p>7 And if a man sell his daughter to be a maidservant, she shall not go out as the menservants do.</p> | When a man sells his daughter as a slave, she shall not go out as the male slaves do. |
| <p>8 If she please not her master, who hath betrothed her to himself, then shall he let her be redeemed: to sell her unto a strange nation he shall have no power, seeing he hath dealt deceitfully with her.</p> | If she does not please her master, who has designated her for Himself, then He shall let her be redeemed. He shall have no right to sell her to a foreign people, since He has broken faith with her. |

- 9 *And if he have betrothed her unto his son, he shall deal with her after the manner of daughters.* If He designates her for His son, He shall deal with her as with a daughter.
- 10 *If he take him another wife; her food, her raiment, and her duty of marriage, shall he not diminish.* If He takes another wife to Himself, He shall not diminish her food, her clothing, or her marital rights.
- 11 *And if he do not these three unto her, then shall she go out free without money.* if He does not do these three things for her, she shall go out for nothing, without payment of money.
- 12 *He that smiteth a man, so that he die, shall be surely put to death.* Whoever strikes a man so that he dies shall be put to death.
- 13 *And if a man lie not in wait, but God deliver him into his hand; then I will appoint thee a place whither he shall flee.* But if He did not lie in wait, but God let Him fall into His hand, then I will appoint for You a place to which He may flee.
- 14 *But if a man come presumptuously upon his neighbour, to slay him with guile; thou shalt take him from mine altar, that he may die.* But if a man willfully attacks another to kill him by cunning, You shall take Him from my altar, that He may die.
- 15 *And he that smiteth his father, or his mother, shall be surely put to death.* Whoever strikes his father or his mother shall be put to death.
- 16 *And he that stealeth a man, and selleth him, or if he be found in his hand, he shall surely be put to death.* Whoever steals a man and sells him, and anyone found in possession of him, shall be put to death.
- 17 *And he that curseth his father, or his mother, shall surely be put to death.* Whoever curses his father or his mother shall be put to death.
- 18 *And if men strive together, and one smite another with a stone, or with his fist, and he die not, but keepeth his bed:* When men quarrel and one strikes the other with a stone or with his fist and the man does not die but takes to his bed,

- 19 *If he rise again, and walk abroad upon his staff, then shall he that smote him be quit: only he shall pay for the loss of his time, and shall cause him to be thoroughly healed.* then if the man rises again and walks outdoors with his staff, he who struck him shall be clear; only he shall pay for the loss of his time, and shall have him thoroughly healed.
- 20 *And if a man smite his servant, or his maid, with a rod, and he die under his hand; he shall be surely punished.* When a man strikes his slave, male or female, with a rod and the slave dies under his hand, he shall be avenged.
- 21 *Notwithstanding, if he continue a day or two, he shall not be punished: for he is his money.* But if the slave survives a day or two, he is not to be avenged, for the slave is his money.
- 22 *If men strive, and hurt a woman with child, so that her fruit depart from her, and yet no mischief follow: he shall be surely punished, according as the woman's husband will lay upon him; and he shall pay as the judges determine.* When men strive together and hit a pregnant woman, so that her children come out, but there is no harm, the one who hit her shall surely be fined, as the woman's husband shall impose on him. He shall pay as the judges determine.
- 23 *And if any mischief follow, then thou shalt give life for life,* But if there is harm, then you shall pay life for life,
- 24 *Eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot,* eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot,
- 25 *Burning for burning, wound for wound, stripe for stripe.* burn for burn, wound for wound, stripe for stripe.
- 26 *And if a man smite the eye of his servant, or the eye of his maid, that it perish; he shall let him go free for his eye's sake.* When a man strikes the eye of his slave, male or female, and destroys it, he shall let the slave go free because of his eye.
- 27 *And if he smite out his manservant's tooth, or his maidservant's tooth; he shall let him go free for his tooth's sake.* If he knocks out the tooth of his slave, male or female, he shall let the slave go free because of his tooth.

- 28 *If an ox gore a man or a woman, that they die: then the ox shall be surely stoned, and his flesh shall not be eaten; but the owner of the ox shall be quit.* When an ox gores a man or a woman to death, the ox shall be stoned, and its flesh shall not be eaten, but the owner of the ox shall not be liable.
- 29 *But if the ox were wont to push with his horn in time past, and it hath been testified to his owner, and he hath not kept him in, but that he hath killed a man or a woman; the ox shall be stoned, and his owner also shall be put to death.* But if the ox has been accustomed to gore in the past, and its owner has been warned but has not kept it in, and it kills a man or a woman, the ox shall be stoned, and its owner also shall be put to death.
- 30 *If there be laid on him a sum of money, then he shall give for the ransom of his life whatsoever is laid upon him.* If a ransom is imposed on him, then he shall give for the redemption of his life whatever is imposed on him.
- 31 *Whether he have gored a son, or have gored a daughter, according to this judgment shall it be done unto him.* If it gores a man's son or daughter, he shall be dealt with according to this same rule.
- 32 *If the ox shall push a manservant or a maidservant; he shall give unto their master thirty shekels of silver, and the ox shall be stoned.* If the ox gores a slave, male or female, the owner shall give to their master thirty shekels of silver, and the ox shall be stoned.
- 33 *And if a man shall open a pit, or if a man shall dig a pit, and not cover it, and an ox or an ass fall therein;* When a man opens a pit, or when a man digs a pit and does not cover it, and an ox or a donkey falls into it,
- 34 *The owner of the pit shall make it good, and give money unto the owner of them; and the dead beast shall be his.* the owner of the pit shall make restoration. He shall give money to its owner, and the dead beast shall be his.
- 35 *And if one man's ox hurt another's, that he die; then they shall sell the live ox, and divide the money of it; and the dead ox also they shall divide.* When one man's ox butts another's, so that it dies, then they shall sell the live ox and share its price, and the dead beast also they shall share.

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Or if it be known that the ox hath used to push in time past, and his owner hath not kept him in; he shall surely pay ox for ox; and the dead shall be his own.
- Or if it is known that the ox has been accustomed to gore in the past, and its owner has not kept it in, he shall repay ox for ox, and the dead beast shall be his.

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 4:14
- v2 — Deut 15:12-15
- v6 — Deut 15:17
- v12 — Gen 9:6; Matt 26:52; Lev 24:17; Num 35:30-31
- v13 — Josh 20:2-9; 1 Sam 24:18
- v14 — 1 Kgs 2:28-34
- v16 — Deut 24:7; 1 Tim 1:10
- v17 — Prov 20:20; Mark 7:10-11
- v22 — Deut 22:18-19; Ex 21:30
- v24 — Deut 19:21; Matt 7:2; Matt 5:38-40
- v32 — Zech 11:12-13; Matt 26:15

Chapter 22

Laws governing theft, property damage, and restitution are given, including penalties for stealing livestock, damage by fire, and breach of trust over goods left in safekeeping. Laws regarding sexual sin, sorcery, idolatry, and the treatment of strangers, widows, and orphans are established. Commands are given against lending at interest to the poor, against reviling God or rulers, and requiring firstfruits and firstborn to be given to the LORD.

- 1

If a man shall steal an ox, or a sheep, and kill it, or sell it; he shall restore five oxen for an ox, and four sheep for a sheep.
- If a man steals an ox or a sheep, and kills it or sells it, He shall repay five oxen for an ox, and four sheep for a sheep.
- 2

If a thief be found breaking up, and be smitten that he die, there shall no blood be shed for him.
- If a thief is found breaking in and is struck so that He dies, there shall be no bloodguilt for Him,

- 3 *If the sun be risen upon him, there shall be blood shed for him; for he should make full restitution; if he have nothing, then he shall be sold for his theft.* but if the sun has risen on Him, there shall be bloodguilt for Him. He shall surely pay. If He has nothing, then He shall be sold for His theft.
- 4 *If the theft be certainly found in his hand alive, whether it be ox, or ass, or sheep; he shall restore double.* If the stolen beast is found alive in His possession, whether it is an ox or a donkey or a sheep, He shall pay double.
- 5 *If a man shall cause a field or vineyard to be eaten, and shall put in his beast, and shall feed in another man's field; of the best of his own field, and of the best of his own vineyard, shall he make restitution.* If a man causes a field or vineyard to be grazed over, or lets His beast loose and it feeds in another man's field, He shall make restitution from the best in His own field and in His own vineyard.
- 6 *If fire break out, and catch in thorns, so that the stacks of corn, or the standing corn, or the field, be consumed therewith; he that kindled the fire shall surely make restitution.* If fire breaks out and catches in thorns so that the stacked grain or the standing grain or the field is consumed, He who started the fire shall make full restitution.
- 7 *If a man shall deliver unto his neighbour money or stuff to keep, and it be stolen out of the man's house; if the thief be found, let him pay double.* If a man gives to his neighbor money or goods to keep safe, and it is stolen from the man's house, then, if the thief is found, he shall pay double.
- 8 *If the thief be not found, then the master of the house shall be brought unto the judges, to see whether he have put his hand unto his neighbour's goods.* If the thief is not found, the owner of the house shall come near to the judges to determine whether he has put his hand to his neighbor's property.

- 9 *For all manner of trespass, whether it be for ox, for ass, for sheep, for raiment, or for any manner of lost thing, which another challengeth to be his, the cause of both parties shall come before the judges; and whom the judges shall condemn, he shall pay double unto his neighbour.* For every breach of trust, whether it is for an ox, for a donkey, for a sheep, for a cloak, or for any kind of lost thing, of which one says, This is it, the case of both parties shall come before the judges. The one whom the judges condemn shall pay double to his neighbor.
- 10 *If a man deliver unto his neighbour an ass, or an ox, or a sheep, or any beast, to keep; and it die, or be hurt, or driven away, no man seeing it:* If a man gives to his neighbor a donkey or an ox or a sheep or any beast to keep safe, and it dies or is injured or is driven away, without anyone seeing it,
- 11 *Then shall an oath of the LORD be between them both, that he hath not put his hand unto his neighbour's goods; and the owner of it shall accept thereof, and he shall not make it good.* an oath by the LORD shall be between them both to see whether or not He has put His hand to His neighbor's property. The owner shall accept the oath. He shall not make restitution.
- 12 *And if it be stolen from him, he shall make restitution unto the owner thereof.* But if it is stolen from Him, He shall make restitution to its owner.
- 13 *If it be torn in pieces, then let him bring it for witness, and he shall not make good that which was torn.* If it is torn by beasts, let Him bring it as evidence. He shall not make restitution for what has been torn.
- 14 *And if a man borrow ought of his neighbour, and it be hurt, or die, the owner thereof being not with it, he shall surely make it good.* If a man borrows anything of his neighbor, and it is injured or dies, the owner not being with it, He shall make full restitution.
- 15 *But if the owner thereof be with it, he shall not make it good: if it be an hired thing, it came for his hire.* If the owner was with it, He shall not make restitution; if it was hired, it came for its hiring fee.
- 16 *And if a man entice a maid that is not betrothed, and lie with her, he shall surely endow her to be his wife.* If a man seduces a virgin who is not betrothed and lies with her, He shall give the bride price for her and make her his wife.

- 17 *If her father utterly refuse to give her unto him, he shall pay money according to the dowry of virgins.* If her father utterly refuses to give her to Him, He shall pay money equal to the bride price for virgins.
- 18 *Thou shalt not suffer a witch to live.* You shall not permit a sorceress to live.
- 19 *Whosoever lieth with a beast shall surely be put to death.* Whoever lies with an animal shall be put to death.
- 20 *He that sacrificeth unto any god, save unto the LORD only, he shall be utterly destroyed.* Whoever sacrifices to any god, other than the LORD alone, shall be devoted to destruction.
- 21 *Thou shalt neither vex a stranger, nor oppress him: for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.* You shall not wrong a sojourner or oppress Him, for You were sojourners in the land of Egypt.
- 22 *Ye shall not afflict any widow, or fatherless child.* You shall not mistreat any widow or fatherless child.
- 23 *If thou afflict them in any wise, and they cry at all unto me, I will surely hear their cry;* If You do mistreat them, and they cry out to me, I will surely hear their cry,
- 24 *And my wrath shall wax hot, and I will kill you with the sword; and your wives shall be widows, and your children fatherless.* my wrath will burn. I will kill You with the sword, and Your wives shall become widows and Your children fatherless.
- 25 *If thou lend money to any of my people that is poor by thee, thou shalt not be to him as an usurer, neither shalt thou lay upon him usury.* If You lend money to any of my people with You who is poor, You shall not be like a moneylender to Him, and You shall not exact interest from Him.
- 26 *If thou at all take thy neighbour's raiment to pledge, thou shalt deliver it unto him by that the sun goeth down:* If ever You take Your neighbor's cloak in pledge, You shall return it to Him before the sun goes down,
- 27 *For that is his covering only, it is his raiment for his skin: wherein shall he sleep? and it shall come to pass, when he crieth unto me, that I will hear; for I am gracious.* for that is His only covering. It is His cloak for His body; in what else shall He sleep? And if He cries to me, I will hear, for I am compassionate.

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| <p>28 <i>Thou shalt not revile the gods, nor curse the ruler of thy people.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Thou shalt not delay to offer the first of thy ripe fruits, and of thy liquors: the firstborn of thy sons shalt thou give unto me.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Likewise shalt thou do with thine oxen, and with thy sheep: seven days it shall be with his dam; on the eighth day thou shalt give it me.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And ye shall be holy men unto me: neither shall ye eat any flesh that is torn of beasts in the field; ye shall cast it to the dogs.</i></p> | <p>You shall not revile God, nor curse a ruler of Your people.</p> <p>You shall not delay to offer from the fullness of Your harvest and from the outflow of Your presses. The firstborn of Your sons You shall give to me.</p> <p>You shall do the same with Your oxen and with Your sheep: seven days it shall be with its mother; on the eighth day You shall give it to me.</p> <p>You shall be consecrated to me. Therefore You shall not eat any flesh that is torn by beasts in the field; You shall throw it to the dogs.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 19:8; 2 Sam 12:6; Prov 6:31
v2 — Matt 24:43; Matt 6:19-20; Num 35:27
v9 — Deut 25:1; Ex 23:6-8; Num 5:6-7; Ex 22:4
v18 — Lev 20:27; Deut 18:10-11; 1 Sam 28:3; Lev 20:6; Rev 22:15
v20 — Deut 17:2-5; Deut 18:20; Num 25:7-8; Deut 13:1-15
v21 — Ex 23:9; Deut 10:19; Lev 19:33
v22 — Isa 1:17; Deut 24:17; Isa 1:23; Zech 7:10; Jas 1:27
v23 — Luke 18:7; Job 34:28; Ps 18:6; Ps 10:17-18; Deut 15:9
v25 — Ps 15:5; Lev 25:35-37; Deut 23:19-20; Ezek 18:8; Prov 28:8
v28 — Eccl 10:20; Acts 23:5; Jude 1:8; Ex 22:8-9; Ex 21:17
v29 — Ex 23:16; Ex 13:2; Ex 23:19; Deut 26:2-10; Jas 1:18
v30 — Lev 22:27; Deut 15:19

Chapter 23

Laws of justice are given: do not follow a crowd to do evil, do not show partiality to the poor in court, return your enemy's stray animal, and let the land rest every seventh year. The three annual feasts are commanded — Unleavened Bread, Harvest, and Ingathering — and the people are forbidden to boil a kid in its mother's milk. The LORD promised to send an angel

before them to drive out the Canaanites, warning Israel not to worship their gods or make covenants with them.

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| 1 | <i>Thou shalt not raise a false report:
put not thine hand with the wicked to
be an unrighteous witness.</i> | You shall not spread a false report.
You shall not join hands with a wicked
man to be a malicious witness. |
| 2 | <i>Thou shalt not follow a multitude to
do evil; neither shalt thou speak in a
cause to decline after many to wrest
judgment:</i> | You shall not fall in with the many to
do evil, nor shall You bear witness in a
lawsuit, siding with the many, so as to
pervert justice, |
| 3 | <i>Neither shalt thou countenance a poor
man in his cause.</i> | nor shall You be partial to a poor man
in His lawsuit. |
| 4 | <i>If thou meet thine enemy's ox or his
ass going astray, thou shalt surely
bring it back to him again.</i> | If You meet Your enemy's ox or his
donkey going astray, You shall bring it
back to Him. |
| 5 | <i>If thou see the ass of him that hateth
thee lying under his burden, and
wouldest forbear to help him, thou
shalt surely help with him.</i> | If You see the donkey of one who
hates You lying down under its burden,
You shall refrain from leaving Him
with it; You shall rescue it with Him. |
| 6 | <i>Thou shalt not wrest the judgment of
thy poor in his cause.</i> | You shall not pervert the justice due to
Your poor in His lawsuit. |
| 7 | <i>Keep thee far from a false matter; and
the innocent and righteous slay thou
not: for I will not justify the wicked.</i> | Keep far from a false charge, and do
not kill the innocent and righteous, for
I will not acquit the wicked. |
| 8 | <i>And thou shalt take no gift: for the gift
blindeth the wise, and perverteth the
words of the righteous.</i> | you shall take no bribe, for a bribe
blinds the clear-sighted and subverts
the cause of those who are in the right. |
| 9 | <i>Also thou shalt not oppress a
stranger: for ye know the heart of a
stranger, seeing ye were strangers in
the land of Egypt.</i> | You shall not oppress a sojourner. You
know the heart of a sojourner, for you
were sojourners in the land of Egypt. |
| 10 | <i>And six years thou shalt sow thy land,
and shalt gather in the fruits thereof:</i> | For six years you shall sow your land
and gather in its yield, |

- 11 *But the seventh year thou shalt let it rest and lie still; that the poor of thy people may eat: and what they leave the beasts of the field shall eat. In like manner thou shalt deal with thy vineyard, and with thy oliveyard.* but the seventh year you shall let it rest and lie fallow, that the poor of your people may eat. What they leave the beasts of the field may eat. You shall do likewise with your vineyard, and with your olive orchard.
- 12 *Six days thou shalt do thy work, and on the seventh day thou shalt rest: that thine ox and thine ass may rest, and the son of thy handmaid, and the stranger, may be refreshed.* Six days you shall do your work, but on the seventh day you shall rest, that your ox and your donkey may have rest, and the son of your servant woman, and the sojourner, may be refreshed.
- 13 *And in all things that I have said unto you be circumspect: and make no mention of the name of other gods, neither let it be heard out of thy mouth.* Pay attention to all that I have said to you, and make no mention of the names of other gods, nor let it be heard on your lips.
- 14 *Three times thou shalt keep a feast unto me in the year.* Three times in the year you shall keep a feast to me.
- 15 *Thou shalt keep the feast of unleavened bread: (thou shalt eat unleavened bread seven days, as I commanded thee, in the time appointed of the month Abib; for in it thou camest out from Egypt: and none shall appear before me empty:)* You shall keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread. As I commanded you, you shall eat unleavened bread for seven days at the appointed time in the month of Abib, for in it you came out of Egypt. None shall appear before me empty-handed.
- 16 *And the feast of harvest, the firstfruits of thy labours, which thou hast sown in the field: and the feast of ingathering, which is in the end of the year, when thou hast gathered in thy labours out of the field.* You shall keep the Feast of Harvest, of the firstfruits of your labor, of what you sow in the field. You shall keep the Feast of Ingathering at the end of the year, when you gather in from the field the fruit of your labor.
- 17 *Three times in the year all thy males shall appear before the Lord GOD.* Three times in the year shall all Your males appear before the Lord GOD.

- 18 *Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leavened bread; neither shall the fat of my sacrifice remain until the morning.* You shall not offer the blood of my sacrifice with anything leavened, or let the fat of my feast remain until the morning.
- 19 *The first of the firstfruits of thy land thou shalt bring into the house of the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother's milk.* The best of the firstfruits of Your ground You shall bring into the house of the LORD Your God. You shall not boil a young goat in its mother's milk.
- 20 *Behold, I send an Angel before thee, to keep thee in the way, and to bring thee into the place which I have prepared.* I send an angel before You to guard You on the way and to bring You to the place that I have prepared.
- 21 *Beware of him, and obey his voice, provoke him not; for he will not pardon your transgressions: for my name is in him.* Pay careful attention to Him and obey His voice; do not rebel against Him, for He will not pardon Your transgression, for my name is in Him.
- 22 *But if thou shalt indeed obey his voice, and do all that I speak; then I will be an enemy unto thine enemies, and an adversary unto thine adversaries.* But if You carefully obey His voice and do all that I say, then I will be an enemy to Your enemies and an adversary to Your adversaries.
- 23 *For mine Angel shall go before thee, and bring thee in unto the Amorites, and the Hittites, and the Perizzites, and the Canaanites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites: and I will cut them off.* When my angel goes before You and brings You to the Amorites and the Hittites and the Perizzites and the Canaanites, the Hivites and the Jebusites, and I will cut them off,
- 24 *Thou shalt not bow down to their gods, nor serve them, nor do after their works: but thou shalt utterly overthrow them, and quite break down their images.* you shall not bow down to their gods nor serve them, nor do as they do, but You shall utterly overthrow them and break their pillars in pieces.
- 25 *And ye shall serve the LORD your God, and he shall bless thy bread, and thy water; and I will take sickness away from the midst of thee.* You shall serve the LORD Your God. He will bless Your bread and Your water. I will take sickness away from among You.

- 26 *There shall nothing cast their young, nor be barren, in thy land: the number of thy days I will fulfil.* None shall miscarry or be barren in Your land; I will fulfill the number of Your days.
- 27 *I will send my fear before thee, and will destroy all the people to whom thou shalt come, and I will make all thine enemies turn their backs unto thee.* I will send my terror before You and will throw into confusion all the people against whom you shall come. I will make all Your enemies turn their backs to You.
- 28 *And I will send hornets before thee, which shall drive out the Hivite, the Canaanite, and the Hittite, from before thee.* I will send hornets before You, which shall drive out the Hivites, the Canaanites, and the Hittites from before You.
- 29 *I will not drive them out from before thee in one year; lest the land become desolate, and the beast of the field multiply against thee.* I will not drive them out from before You in one year, lest the land become desolate and the wild beasts multiply against You.
- 30 *By little and little I will drive them out from before thee, until thou be increased, and inherit the land.* Little by little I will drive them out from before You, until You have increased and possess the land.
- 31 *And I will set thy bounds from the Red sea even unto the sea of the Philistines, and from the desert unto the river: for I will deliver the inhabitants of the land into your hand; and thou shalt drive them out before thee.* I will set Your border from the Red Sea to the Sea of the Philistines, and from the wilderness to the Euphrates, for I will give the inhabitants of the land into Your hand, and You shall drive them out before You.
- 32 *Thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor with their gods.* You shall make no covenant with them and their gods.
- 33 *They shall not dwell in thy land, lest they make thee sin against me: for if thou serve their gods, it will surely be a snare unto thee.* They shall not dwell in Your land, lest they make You sin against me; for if You serve their gods, it will surely be a snare to You.'

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 101:5; Prov 19:5; Deut 19:16-21; Ex 20:16; Matt 26:59-61
- v2 — Prov 1:10-11; Prov 1:15; Luke 23:23-24; Matt 27:24-26; Job 31:34
- v8 — Deut 16:19; Prov 17:23; Isa 5:23; Prov 15:27; 1 Sam 8:3
- v13 — Josh 23:7; Zech 13:2; Deut 4:9; 1 Tim 4:16; Hos 2:17
- v20 — Ex 33:14; Ps 91:11; Ex 32:34; Ex 14:19; Isa 63:9
- v21 — Ps 78:56; Ps 78:40; Heb 12:25; John 10:38; John 10:30
- v22 — Gen 12:3; Deut 30:7; Zech 2:8; Jer 30:20; Acts 9:4-5
- v25 — Deut 7:15; Ex 15:26; Josh 22:5; Isa 33:24; Ps 103:3
- v26 — Deut 7:14; Deut 28:4; Job 5:26; Job 21:10; Isa 65:20
- v27 — Deut 2:25; Gen 35:5; Deut 11:25; Deut 7:23; Ex 15:14-16
- v29 — Deut 7:22; Judg 3:1-4; Josh 17:12-13; Josh 16:10; Josh 15:63
- v32 — Deut 7:2; Ex 34:12; Ex 34:15; Deut 7:16; Ps 106:35

Chapter 24

Moses read the book of the covenant to the people and they answered "All that the LORD has said we will do, and be obedient"; he sprinkled blood on them to ratify the covenant. Moses, Aaron, Nadab, Abihu, and seventy elders went up and saw the God of Israel with a pavement of sapphire under his feet, and they ate and drank. The LORD called Moses up into the mountain, where he stayed forty days and forty nights to receive the tables of stone.

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| <p>1 <i>And he said unto Moses, Come up unto the LORD, thou, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel; and worship ye afar off.</i></p> | <p>Then He said to Moses, 'Come up to the LORD, you and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel, and worship from afar.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And Moses alone shall come near the LORD: but they shall not come nigh; neither shall the people go up with him.</i></p> | <p>Moses alone shall come near to the LORD, but the others shall not come near, and the people shall not come up with him.'</p> |

- 3 *And Moses came and told the people all the words of the LORD, and all the judgments: and all the people answered with one voice, and said, All the words which the LORD hath said will we do.* Moses came and told the people all the words of the LORD and all the rules. And all the people answered with one voice and said, 'All the words that the LORD has spoken we will do.'
- 4 *And Moses wrote all the words of the LORD, and rose up early in the morning, and builded an altar under the hill, and twelve pillars, according to the twelve tribes of Israel.* Moses wrote down all the words of the LORD. He rose early in the morning and built an altar at the foot of the mountain, and twelve pillars, according to the twelve tribes of Israel.
- 5 *And he sent young men of the children of Israel, which offered burnt offerings, and sacrificed peace offerings of oxen unto the LORD.* he sent young men of the children of Israel, who offered burnt offerings and sacrificed peace offerings of oxen to the LORD.
- 6 *And Moses took half of the blood, and put it in basons; and half of the blood he sprinkled on the altar.* Moses took half of the blood and put it in basins, and half of the blood he threw against the altar.
- 7 *And he took the book of the covenant, and read in the audience of the people: and they said, All that the LORD hath said will we do, and be obedient.* Then He took the Book of the Covenant and read it in the hearing of the people. And they said, 'All that the LORD has spoken we will do. We will be obedient.'
- 8 *And Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it on the people, and said, Behold the blood of the covenant, which the LORD hath made with you concerning all these words.* Moses took the blood and threw it on the people and said, ' the blood of the covenant that the LORD has made with You in accordance with all these words.'
- 9 *Then went up Moses, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel:* Then Moses and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel went up,

- 10 *And they saw the God of Israel: and there was under his feet as it were a paved work of a sapphire stone, and as it were the body of heaven in his clearness.* they saw the God of Israel. There was under His feet as it were a pavement of sapphire stone, like the very heaven for clearness.
- 11 *And upon the nobles of the children of Israel he laid not his hand: also they saw God, and did eat and drink.* he did not lay his hand on the chief men of the children of Israel; they beheld God, and ate and drank.
- 12 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Come up to me into the mount, and be there: and I will give thee tables of stone, and a law, and commandments which I have written; that thou mayest teach them.* The LORD said to Moses, 'Come up to me on the mountain and wait there, that I may give you the tablets of stone, with the law and the commandment, which I have written for their instruction.'
- 13 *And Moses rose up, and his minister Joshua: and Moses went up into the mount of God.* So Moses rose with his assistant Joshua, and Moses went up into the mountain of God.
- 14 *And he said unto the elders, Tarry ye here for us, until we come again unto you: and, behold, Aaron and Hur are with you: if any man have any matters to do, let him come unto them.* he said to the elders, 'Wait here for us until we return to you. And Aaron and Hur are with you. Whoever has a dispute, let him go to them.'
- 15 *And Moses went up into the mount, and a cloud covered the mount.* Then Moses went up on the mountain, and the cloud covered the mountain.
- 16 *And the glory of the LORD abode upon mount Sinai, and the cloud covered it six days: and the seventh day he called unto Moses out of the midst of the cloud.* The glory of the LORD lived on Mount Sinai, and the cloud covered it six days. And on the seventh day He called to Moses out of the midst of the cloud.
- 17 *And the sight of the glory of the LORD was like devouring fire on the top of the mount in the eyes of the children of Israel.* Now the appearance of the glory of the LORD was like a devouring fire on the top of the mountain in the sight of the children of Israel.

- 18

And Moses went into the midst of the cloud, and gat him up into the mount: and Moses was in the mount forty days and forty nights.
- Moses entered the cloud and went up on the mountain. And Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Num 11:16; Ex 6:23
- v3** — Ex 19:8; Ex 24:7; Josh 24:22
- v6** — 1 Pet 1:19; Ex 24:8; Heb 9:18
- v7** — Deut 31:11-13; Ex 24:3-4; Heb 9:18-23; 1 Thess 5:27; Acts 13:15
- v8** — Heb 10:4-5; Ex 24:6; Ezek 36:25; Matt 26:28; 1 Cor 11:25
- v10** — John 1:18; Ezek 10:1; Gen 32:30; Ex 33:20; Ex 33:23
- v11** — Luke 15:23-24; Ex 18:12
- v12** — Deut 5:22; Ex 31:18; Ex 32:15-16; Heb 9:4
- v15** — Ex 19:9; Matt 17:5
- v16** — Ex 16:10; Num 16:42; Ezek 1:28
- v17** — Heb 12:29; Deut 4:24; Ex 3:2; Heb 12:18; Deut 4:36
- v18** — Deut 9:9; Ex 34:28; Deut 10:10

Chapter 25

The LORD commanded Israel to bring a freewill offering of gold, silver, bronze, fine fabrics, skins, wood, oil, spices, and precious stones to build a sanctuary that he might dwell among them. Detailed instructions are given for the ark of the covenant — overlaid with gold, with a mercy seat and two cherubim — the table of showbread, and the seven-branched golden lampstand, all to be made according to the pattern shown on the mountain.

- 1

And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
- The LORD said to Moses,
- 2

Speak unto the children of Israel, that they bring me an offering: of every man that giveth it willingly with his heart ye shall take my offering.
- 'Speak to the children of Israel, that they take for me a contribution. From every man whose heart moves him you shall receive the contribution for me.

- 3 *And this is the offering which ye shall take of them; gold, and silver, and brass,* this is the contribution that You shall receive from them: gold, silver, and bronze,
- 4 *And blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair,* blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine linen and goats' hair,
- 5 *And rams' skins dyed red, and badgers' skins, and shittim wood,* tanned rams' skins, goatskins, acacia wood,
- 6 *Oil for the light, spices for anointing oil, and for sweet incense,* oil for the lamps, spices for the anointing oil and for the fragrant incense,
- 7 *Onyx stones, and stones to be set in the ephod, and in the breastplate.* onyx stones, and stones for setting, for the ephod and for the breastpiece.
- 8 *And let them make me a sanctuary; that I may dwell among them.* let them make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell in their midst.
- 9 *According to all that I shew thee, after the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all the instruments thereof, even so shall ye make it.* Exactly as I show You concerning the pattern of the tabernacle, and of all its furniture, so You shall make it.
- 10 *And they shall make an ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half shall be the length thereof, and a cubit and a half the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof.* They shall make an ark of acacia wood. Two and a half cubits shall be its length, a cubit and a half its breadth, and a cubit and a half its height.
- 11 *And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, within and without shalt thou overlay it, and shalt make upon it a crown of gold round about.* You shall overlay it with pure gold, inside and outside shall You overlay it, and You shall make on it a molding of gold around it.
- 12 *And thou shalt cast four rings of gold for it, and put them in the four corners thereof; and two rings shall be in the one side of it, and two rings in the other side of it.* You shall cast four rings of gold for it and put them on its four feet, two rings on the one side of it, and two rings on the other side of it.
- 13 *And thou shalt make staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold.* You shall make poles of acacia wood and overlay them with gold.

- 14 *And thou shalt put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, that the ark may be borne with them.* you shall put the poles into the rings on the sides of the ark to carry the ark by them.
- 15 *The staves shall be in the rings of the ark: they shall not be taken from it.* The poles shall remain in the rings of the ark; they shall not be taken from it.
- 16 *And thou shalt put into the ark the testimony which I shall give thee.* you shall put into the ark the testimony that I shall give You.
- 17 *And thou shalt make a mercy seat of pure gold: two cubits and a half shall be the length thereof, and a cubit and a half the breadth thereof.* You shall make a mercy seat of pure gold. Two and a half cubits shall be its length, and a cubit and a half its breadth.
- 18 *And thou shalt make two cherubims of gold, of beaten work shalt thou make them, in the two ends of the mercy seat.* you shall make two cherubim of gold; of hammered work shall You make them, on the two ends of the mercy seat.
- 19 *And make one cherub on the one end, and the other cherub on the other end: even of the mercy seat shall ye make the cherubims on the two ends thereof.* Make one cherub on the one end, and one cherub on the other end. Of one piece with the mercy seat shall You make the cherubim on its two ends.
- 20 *And the cherubims shall stretch forth their wings on high, covering the mercy seat with their wings, and their faces shall look one to another; toward the mercy seat shall the faces of the cherubims be.* The cherubim shall spread out their wings above, overshadowing the mercy seat with their wings, their faces one to another; toward the mercy seat shall the faces of the cherubim be.
- 21 *And thou shalt put the mercy seat above upon the ark; and in the ark thou shalt put the testimony that I shall give thee.* you shall put the mercy seat on the top of the ark, and in the ark You shall put the testimony that I shall give You.

- 22 *And there I will meet with thee, and I will commune with thee from above the mercy seat, from between the two cherubims which are upon the ark of the testimony, of all things which I will give thee in commandment unto the children of Israel.* There I will meet with You, and from above the mercy seat, from between the two cherubim that are on the ark of the testimony, I will speak with You about all that I will give You in commandment for the children of Israel.
- 23 *Thou shalt also make a table of shittim wood: two cubits shall be the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof.* You shall make a table of acacia wood. Two cubits shall be its length, a cubit its breadth, and a cubit and a half its height.
- 24 *And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, and make thereto a crown of gold round about.* You shall overlay it with pure gold and make a molding of gold around it.
- 25 *And thou shalt make unto it a border of an hand breadth round about, and thou shalt make a golden crown to the border thereof round about.* you shall make a rim around it a handbreadth wide, and a molding of gold around the rim.
- 26 *And thou shalt make for it four rings of gold, and put the rings in the four corners that are on the four feet thereof.* you shall make for it four rings of gold, and fasten the rings to the four corners at its four legs.
- 27 *Over against the border shall the rings be for places of the staves to bear the table.* Close to the frame the rings shall lie, as holders for the poles to carry the table.
- 28 *And thou shalt make the staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold, that the table may be borne with them.* You shall make the poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold, and the table shall be carried with these.
- 29 *And thou shalt make the dishes thereof, and spoons thereof, and covers thereof, and bowls thereof, to cover withal: of pure gold shalt thou make them.* you shall make its plates and dishes for incense, and its flagons and bowls with which to pour drink offerings; You shall make them of pure gold.

- 30 *And thou shalt set upon the table shewbread before me alway.* you shall set the bread of the Presence on the table before me regularly.
- 31 *And thou shalt make a candlestick of pure gold: of beaten work shall the candlestick be made: his shaft, and his branches, his bowls, his knops, and his flowers, shall be of the same.* You shall make a lampstand of pure gold. The lampstand shall be made of hammered work: its base, its stem, its cups, its calyxes, and its flowers shall be of one piece with it.
- 32 *And six branches shall come out of the sides of it; three branches of the candlestick out of the one side, and three branches of the candlestick out of the other side:* there shall be six branches going out of its sides, three branches of the lampstand out of one side of it and three branches of the lampstand out of the other side of it;
- 33 *Three bowls made like unto almonds, with a knop and a flower in one branch; and three bowls made like almonds in the other branch, with a knop and a flower: so in the six branches that come out of the candlestick.* three cups made like almond blossoms, each with calyx and flower, on one branch, and three cups made like almond blossoms, each with calyx and flower, on the other branch — so for the six branches going out of the lampstand.
- 34 *And in the candlesticks shall be four bowls made like unto almonds, with their knops and their flowers.* on the lampstand itself there shall be four cups made like almond blossoms, with their calyxes and flowers,
- 35 *And there shall be a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, according to the six branches that proceed out of the candlestick.* a calyx of one piece with it under each pair of the six branches going out from the lampstand.
- 36 *Their knops and their branches shall be of the same: all it shall be one beaten work of pure gold.* Their calyxes and their branches shall be of one piece with it, the whole of it a single piece of hammered work of pure gold.

37	<i>And thou shalt make the seven lamps thereof; and they shall light the lamps thereof, that they may give light over against it.</i>	You shall make seven lamps for it. And the lamps shall be set up so as to give light on the space in front of it.
38	<i>And the tongs thereof, and the snuffdishes thereof, shall be of pure gold.</i>	Its tongs and their trays shall be of pure gold.
39	<i>Of a talent of pure gold shall he make it, with all these vessels.</i>	It shall be made, with all these utensils, out of a talent of pure gold.
40	<i>And look that thou make them after their pattern, which was shewed thee in the mount.</i>	see that You make them after the pattern for them, which is being shown You on the mountain.'

Words in this chapter:

- mercy seat** — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.
- tabernacle** — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.
- ark of the testimony** — Another name for the ark of the covenant — 'testimony' refers to the tablets of the law stored inside it.
- breastplate** — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.
- candlestick** — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.
- cherubim** (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.
- ephod** (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Cross-References:

- v2** — 2 Cor 9:7; Neh 11:2; Ezra 2:68; Ezra 1:6; Ezra 7:16
- v6** — Ex 27:20
- v7** — Ex 28:4
- v8** — 2 Cor 6:16; 1 Kgs 6:13; Rev 21:3; Ex 29:45; Heb 9:1-2
- v9** — Ex 25:40; Heb 8:5; Acts 7:44
- v16** — 1 Kgs 8:9; Deut 31:26
- v20** — 1 Kgs 8:7; 1 Chr 28:18

v22 — Ex 29:42-43; Num 7:89; Isa 37:16; Ps 80:1; 2 Kgs 19:15

v30 — Matt 12:4; Lev 24:5-9

v31 — 1 Kgs 7:49; Zech 4:2; Ex 37:17-24

v37 — Num 8:2; Rev 1:20-2:1

v40 — Heb 8:5; Acts 7:44; Ex 26:30; Num 8:4; Ex 25:9

Chapter 26

Instructions are given for the tabernacle's curtains: ten inner curtains of fine linen with blue, purple, and scarlet, joined by loops and clasps, and eleven curtains of goat hair for the tent covering above. The framework of the tabernacle is described — boards of acacia wood overlaid with gold set in silver sockets — along with the veil of blue, purple, and scarlet separating the holy place from the most holy place.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover thou shalt make the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet: with cherubims of cunning work shalt thou make them.</i></p> | <p>'Moreover, you shall make the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen and blue and purple and scarlet yarns; you shall make them with cherubim skillfully worked into them.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The length of one curtain shall be eight and twenty cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: and every one of the curtains shall have one measure.</i></p> | <p>The length of each curtain shall be 28 cubits, and the breadth of each curtain 4 cubits; all the curtains shall be the same size.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The five curtains shall be coupled together one to another; and other five curtains shall be coupled one to another.</i></p> | <p>Five curtains shall be coupled to one another, and the other five curtains shall be coupled to one another.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And thou shalt make loops of blue upon the edge of the one curtain from the selvedge in the coupling; and likewise shalt thou make in the uttermost edge of another curtain, in the coupling of the second.</i></p> | <p>you shall make loops of blue on the edge of the outermost curtain in the first set. Likewise you shall make them on the edge of the outermost curtain in the second set.</p> |

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| <p>5 <i>Fifty loops shalt thou make in the one curtain, and fifty loops shalt thou make in the edge of the curtain that is in the coupling of the second; that the loops may take hold one of another.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And thou shalt make fifty taches of gold, and couple the curtains together with the taches: and it shall be one tabernacle.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And thou shalt make curtains of goats' hair to be a covering upon the tabernacle: eleven curtains shalt thou make.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The length of one curtain shall be thirty cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: and the eleven curtains shall be all of one measure.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And thou shalt couple five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves, and shalt double the sixth curtain in the forefront of the tabernacle.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And thou shalt make fifty loops on the edge of the one curtain that is outmost in the coupling, and fifty loops in the edge of the curtain which coupleth the second.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And thou shalt make fifty taches of brass, and put the taches into the loops, and couple the tent together, that it may be one.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And the remnant that remaineth of the curtains of the tent, the half curtain that remaineth, shall hang over the backside of the tabernacle.</i></p> | <p>Fifty loops you shall make on the one curtain, and fifty loops you shall make on the edge of the curtain that is in the second set; the loops shall be opposite one another.</p> <p>you shall make fifty clasps of gold, and couple the curtains one to the other with the clasps, so that the tabernacle may be a single whole.</p> <p>You shall also make curtains of goats' hair for a tent over the tabernacle; eleven curtains shall you make.</p> <p>The length of each curtain shall be 30 cubits, and the breadth of each curtain 4 cubits. The eleven curtains shall be the same size.</p> <p>You shall couple five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves, and the sixth curtain you shall double over at the front of the tent.</p> <p>You shall make fifty loops on the edge of the curtain that is outermost in one set, and fifty loops on the edge of the curtain that is outermost in the second set.</p> <p>you shall make fifty clasps of bronze, and put the clasps into the loops, and couple the tent together that it may be a single whole.</p> <p>the part that remains of the curtains of the tent, the half curtain that remains, shall hang over the back of the tabernacle.</p> |
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- 13 *And a cubit on the one side, and a cubit on the other side of that which remaineth in the length of the curtains of the tent, it shall hang over the sides of the tabernacle on this side and on that side, to cover it.* the extra that remains in the length of the curtains, the cubit on the one side, and the cubit on the other side, shall hang over the sides of the tabernacle, on this side and that side, to cover it.
- 14 *And thou shalt make a covering for the tent of rams' skins dyed red, and a covering above of badgers' skins.* you shall make for the tent a covering of tanned rams' skins and a covering of goatskins on top.
- 15 *And thou shalt make boards for the tabernacle of shittim wood standing up.* You shall make upright frames for the tabernacle of acacia wood.
- 16 *Ten cubits shall be the length of a board, and a cubit and a half shall be the breadth of one board.* Ten cubits shall be the length of a frame, and a cubit and a half the breadth of each frame.
- 17 *Two tenons shall there be in one board, set in order one against another: thus shalt thou make for all the boards of the tabernacle.* There shall be two tenons in each frame, for fitting together. So shall you do for all the frames of the tabernacle.
- 18 *And thou shalt make the boards for the tabernacle, twenty boards on the south side southward.* You shall make the frames for the tabernacle: twenty frames for the south side;
- 19 *And thou shalt make forty sockets of silver under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for his two tenons, and two sockets under another board for his two tenons.* forty bases of silver you shall make under the twenty frames, two bases under one frame for its two tenons, and two bases under the next frame for its two tenons;
- 20 *And for the second side of the tabernacle on the north side there shall be twenty boards:* for the second side of the tabernacle, on the north side twenty frames,
- 21 *And their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.* their forty bases of silver, two bases under one frame, and two bases under the next frame.

- 22 *And for the sides of the tabernacle westward thou shalt make six boards.* for the rear of the tabernacle westward you shall make six frames.
- 23 *And two boards shalt thou make for the corners of the tabernacle in the two sides.* you shall make two frames for corners of the tabernacle in the rear;
- 24 *And they shall be coupled together beneath, and they shall be coupled together above the head of it unto one ring; thus shall it be for them both; they shall be for the two corners.* they shall be separate beneath, but joined at the top, at the first ring. Thus shall it be with both of them; they shall form the two corners.
- 25 *And they shall be eight boards, and their sockets of silver, sixteen sockets; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.* there shall be eight frames, with their bases of silver, sixteen bases; two bases under one frame, and two bases under another frame.
- 26 *And thou shalt make bars of shittim wood; five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle,* You shall make bars of acacia wood, five for the frames of the one side of the tabernacle,
- 27 *And five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the side of the tabernacle, for the two sides westward.* five bars for the frames of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the frames of the side of the tabernacle at the rear westward.
- 28 *And the middle bar in the midst of the boards shall reach from end to end.* The middle bar, halfway up the frames, shall run from end to end.
- 29 *And thou shalt overlay the boards with gold, and make their rings of gold for places for the bars: and thou shalt overlay the bars with gold.* You shall overlay the frames with gold and shall make their rings of gold for holders for the bars, and you shall overlay the bars with gold.
- 30 *And thou shalt rear up the tabernacle according to the fashion thereof which was shewed thee in the mount.* Then you shall erect the tabernacle according to the plan for it that you were shown on the mountain.

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| <p>31 <i>And thou shalt make a vail of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen of cunning work: with cherubims shall it be made:</i></p> <p>32 <i>And thou shalt hang it upon four pillars of shittim wood overlaid with gold: their hooks shall be of gold, upon the four sockets of silver.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And thou shalt hang up the vail under the taches, that thou mayest bring in thither within the vail the ark of the testimony: and the vail shall divide unto you between the holy place and the most holy.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And thou shalt put the mercy seat upon the ark of the testimony in the most holy place.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And thou shalt set the table without the vail, and the candlestick over against the table on the side of the tabernacle toward the south: and thou shalt put the table on the north side.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And thou shalt make an hanging for the door of the tent, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, wrought with needlework.</i></p> <p>37 <i>And thou shalt make for the hanging five pillars of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold, and their hooks shall be of gold: and thou shalt cast five sockets of brass for them.</i></p> | <p>you shall make a veil of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen. It shall be made with cherubim skillfully worked into it.</p> <p>you shall hang it on four pillars of acacia overlaid with gold, with hooks of gold, on four bases of silver.</p> <p>you shall hang the veil from the clasps, and bring the ark of the testimony in there within the veil. And the veil shall separate for you the Holy Place from the Most Holy.</p> <p>You shall put the mercy seat on the ark of the testimony in the Most Holy Place.</p> <p>you shall set the table outside the veil, and the lampstand on the south side of the tabernacle opposite the table, and you shall put the table on the north side.</p> <p>You shall make a screen for the entrance of the tent, of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen, embroidered with needlework.</p> <p>you shall make for the screen five pillars of acacia, and overlay them with gold. Their hooks shall be of gold, and you shall cast five bases of bronze for them.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 36:8-19
 v14 — Ex 36:19
 v30 — Ex 25:40; Heb 8:5; Ex 25:9; Acts 7:44
 v31 — Matt 27:51; 2 Chr 3:14
 v34 — Ex 40:20; Ex 25:21
 v35 — Ex 40:22; Ex 40:24

Chapter 27

Instructions are given for the bronze altar of burnt offering, five cubits square and three cubits high, with horns at its four corners, and all its utensils of bronze. The court of the tabernacle is described: hangings of fine linen supported by pillars with silver hooks and bronze sockets, one hundred cubits long and fifty cubits wide. The people are commanded to bring pure beaten olive oil for the lamp to burn continually in the tent of meeting.

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| <p>1 And thou shalt make an altar of shittim wood, five cubits long, and five cubits broad; the altar shall be foursquare: and the height thereof shall be three cubits.</p> | <p>You shall make the altar of acacia wood, five cubits long and five cubits broad. The altar shall be square, and its height shall be three cubits.</p> |
| <p>2 And thou shalt make the horns of it upon the four corners thereof: his horns shall be of the same: and thou shalt overlay it with brass.</p> | <p>you shall make horns for it on its four corners; its horns shall be of one piece with it, and you shall overlay it with bronze.</p> |
| <p>3 And thou shalt make his pans to receive his ashes, and his shovels, and his basons, and his fleshhooks, and his firepans: all the vessels thereof thou shalt make of brass.</p> | <p>You shall make pots for it to receive its ashes, and shovels and basins and forks and fire pans. You shall make all its utensils of bronze.</p> |
| <p>4 And thou shalt make for it a grate of network of brass; and upon the net shalt thou make four brasen rings in the four corners thereof.</p> | <p>You shall also make for it a grating, a network of bronze, and on the net you shall make four bronze rings at its four corners.</p> |
| <p>5 And thou shalt put it under the compass of the altar beneath, that the net may be even to the midst of the altar.</p> | <p>you shall set it under the ledge of the altar so that the net extends halfway down the altar.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And thou shalt make staves for the altar, staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with brass.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the staves shall be put into the rings, and the staves shall be upon the two sides of the altar, to bear it.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Hollow with boards shalt thou make it: as it was shewed thee in the mount, so shall they make it.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And thou shalt make the court of the tabernacle: for the south side southward there shall be hangings for the court of fine twined linen of an hundred cubits long for one side:</i></p> <p>10 <i>And the twenty pillars thereof and their twenty sockets shall be of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets shall be of silver.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And likewise for the north side in length there shall be hangings of an hundred cubits long, and his twenty pillars and their twenty sockets of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And for the breadth of the court on the west side shall be hangings of fifty cubits: their pillars ten, and their sockets ten.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the breadth of the court on the east side eastward shall be fifty cubits.</i></p> <p>14 <i>The hangings of one side of the gate shall be fifteen cubits: their pillars three, and their sockets three.</i></p> | <p>you shall make poles for the altar, poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with bronze.</p> <p>the poles shall be put through the rings, so that the poles are on the two sides of the altar when it is carried.</p> <p>You shall make it hollow, with boards. As it has been shown you on the mountain, so shall it be made.</p> <p>You shall make the court of the tabernacle. On the south side the court shall have hangings of fine twined linen a hundred cubits long for one side.</p> <p>Its twenty pillars and their twenty bases shall be of bronze, but the hooks of the pillars and their fillets shall be of silver.</p> <p>likewise for the north side in length there shall be hangings a hundred cubits long, its pillars twenty and their bases twenty, of bronze, but the hooks of the pillars and their fillets shall be of silver.</p> <p>for the breadth of the court on the west side there shall be hangings for fifty cubits, with ten pillars and ten bases.</p> <p>The breadth of the court on the front to the east shall be fifty cubits.</p> <p>The hangings for the one side of the gate shall be fifteen cubits, with their three pillars and three bases.</p> |
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| <p>15 <i>And on the other side shall be hangings fifteen cubits: their pillars three, and their sockets three.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And for the gate of the court shall be an hanging of twenty cubits, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, wrought with needlework: and their pillars shall be four, and their sockets four.</i></p> <p>17 <i>All the pillars round about the court shall be filleted with silver; their hooks shall be of silver, and their sockets of brass.</i></p> <p>18 <i>The length of the court shall be an hundred cubits, and the breadth fifty every where, and the height five cubits of fine twined linen, and their sockets of brass.</i></p> <p>19 <i>All the vessels of the tabernacle in all the service thereof, and all the pins thereof, and all the pins of the court, shall be of brass.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And thou shalt command the children of Israel, that they bring thee pure oil olive beaten for the light, to cause the lamp to burn always.</i></p> <p>21 <i>In the tabernacle of the congregation without the vail, which is before the testimony, Aaron and his sons shall order it from evening to morning before the LORD: it shall be a statute for ever unto their generations on the behalf of the children of Israel.</i></p> | <p>On the other side the hangings shall be fifteen cubits, with their three pillars and three bases.</p> <p>For the gate of the court there shall be a screen twenty cubits long, of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen, embroidered with needlework. It shall have four pillars and with them four bases.</p> <p>All the pillars around the court shall be filleted with silver; their hooks shall be of silver, and their bases of bronze.</p> <p>The length of the court shall be a hundred cubits, the breadth fifty, and the height five cubits, with hangings of fine twined linen and bases of bronze.</p> <p>All the utensils of the tabernacle for every use, and all its pegs and all the pegs of the court, shall be of bronze.</p> <p>You shall command the children of Israel that they bring to you pure beaten olive oil for the light, that a lamp may regularly be set up to burn.</p> <p>In the tent of meeting, outside the veil that is before the testimony, Aaron and his sons shall tend it from evening to morning before the LORD. It shall be a statute forever to be observed throughout their generations by the children of Israel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 118:27

v8 — Ex 25:40

v20 — Lev 24:1-4; Zech 4:11-14; Ps 23:5

v21 — Num 19:21; Num 18:23; Lev 16:34; 1 Sam 3:3; 2 Chr 13:11

Chapter 28

Instructions are given for the holy garments of Aaron the high priest: the ephod of gold, blue, purple, and scarlet with two onyx shoulder stones engraved with the names of the twelve tribes. The breastplate of judgment, set with twelve precious stones bearing the tribes' names, is described along with the Urim and Thummim. The robe of the ephod, the golden plate inscribed "HOLINESS TO THE LORD" for the mitre, and the linen garments for Aaron's sons are specified.

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| <p>1 And take thou unto thee Aaron thy brother, and his sons with him, from among the children of Israel, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office, even Aaron, Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, Aaron's sons.</p> | <p>Then bring near to you Aaron your brother and his sons with him, from among the children of Israel, to serve me as priests — Aaron and Aaron's sons, Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.</p> |
| <p>2 And thou shalt make holy garments for Aaron thy brother for glory and for beauty.</p> | <p>you shall make holy garments for Aaron your brother, for glory and for beauty.</p> |
| <p>3 And thou shalt speak unto all that are wise hearted, whom I have filled with the spirit of wisdom, that they may make Aaron's garments to consecrate him, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.</p> | <p>You shall speak to all the skillful, whom I have filled with a spirit of skill, that they make Aaron's garments to consecrate him for my priesthood.</p> |

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| 4 | <i>And these are the garments which they shall make; a breastplate, and an ephod, and a robe, and a broidered coat, a mitre, and a girdle: and they shall make holy garments for Aaron thy brother, and his sons, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.</i> | These are the garments that they shall make: a breastpiece, an ephod, a robe, a coat of checker work, a turban, and a sash. They shall make holy garments for Aaron your brother and his sons to serve me as priests. |
| 5 | <i>And they shall take gold, and blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen.</i> | They shall receive gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen. |
| 6 | <i>And they shall make the ephod of gold, of blue, and of purple, of scarlet, and fine twined linen, with cunning work.</i> | they shall make the ephod of gold, of blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and of fine twined linen, skillfully worked. |
| 7 | <i>It shall have the two shoulderpieces thereof joined at the two edges thereof; and so it shall be joined together.</i> | It shall have two shoulder pieces attached to its two edges, so that it may be joined together. |
| 8 | <i>And the curious girdle of the ephod, which is upon it, shall be of the same, according to the work thereof; even of gold, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.</i> | the skillfully woven band on it shall be made like it and be of one piece with it, of gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen. |
| 9 | <i>And thou shalt take two onyx stones, and grave on them the names of the children of Israel:</i> | You shall take two onyx stones, and engrave on them the names of the sons of Israel, |
| 10 | <i>Six of their names on one stone, and the other six names of the rest on the other stone, according to their birth.</i> | six of their names on the one stone, and the names of the remaining six on the other stone, in the order of their birth. |

- 11 *With the work of an engraver in stone, like the engravings of a signet, shalt thou engrave the two stones with the names of the children of Israel: thou shalt make them to be set in ouches of gold.* As a jeweler engraves signets, so shall you engrave the two stones with the names of the sons of Israel. You shall enclose them in settings of gold filigree.
- 12 *And thou shalt put the two stones upon the shoulders of the ephod for stones of memorial unto the children of Israel: and Aaron shall bear their names before the LORD upon his two shoulders for a memorial.* you shall set the two stones on the shoulder pieces of the ephod, as stones of remembrance for the sons of Israel. And Aaron shall bear their names before the LORD on His two shoulders for remembrance.
- 13 *And thou shalt make ouches of gold;* You shall make settings of gold filigree,
- 14 *And two chains of pure gold at the ends; of wreathen work shalt thou make them, and fasten the wreathen chains to the ouches.* two chains of pure gold, twisted like cords. You shall attach the corded chains to the settings.
- 15 *And thou shalt make the breastplate of judgment with cunning work; after the work of the ephod thou shalt make it; of gold, of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, and of fine twined linen, shalt thou make it.* You shall make a breastpiece of judgment, in skilled work. In the style of the ephod You shall make it — of gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen shall You make it.
- 16 *Foursquare it shall be being doubled; a span shall be the length thereof, and a span shall be the breadth thereof.* It shall be square and doubled, a span its length and a span its breadth.
- 17 *And thou shalt set in it settings of stones, even four rows of stones: the first row shall be a sardius, a topaz, and a carbuncle: this shall be the first row.* You shall set in it four rows of stones. A row of sardius, topaz, and carbuncle shall be the first row;
- 18 *And the second row shall be an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond.* the second row an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond;

- 19 *And the third row a ligure, an agate, and an amethyst.* the third row a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst;
- 20 *And the fourth row a beryl, and an onyx, and a jasper: they shall be set in gold in their inclosings.* the fourth row a beryl, an onyx, and a jasper. They shall be set in gold filigree.
- 21 *And the stones shall be with the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names, like the engravings of a signet; every one with his name shall they be according to the twelve tribes.* There shall be twelve stones with their names according to the names of the sons of Israel. They shall be like signets, each engraved with its name, for the twelve tribes.
- 22 *And thou shalt make upon the breastplate chains at the ends of wreathen work of pure gold.* You shall make for the breastpiece twisted chains like cords, of pure gold.
- 23 *And thou shalt make upon the breastplate two rings of gold, and shalt put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate.* you shall make for the breastpiece two rings of gold, and put the two rings on the two edges of the breastpiece.
- 24 *And thou shalt put the two wreathen chains of gold in the two rings which are on the ends of the breastplate.* you shall put the two cords of gold in the two rings at the edges of the breastpiece.
- 25 *And the other two ends of the two wreathen chains thou shalt fasten in the two ouches, and put them on the shoulderpieces of the ephod before it.* The two ends of the two cords You shall attach to the two settings of filigree, and so attach it in front to the shoulder pieces of the ephod.
- 26 *And thou shalt make two rings of gold, and thou shalt put them upon the two ends of the breastplate in the border thereof, which is in the side of the ephod inward.* You shall make two rings of gold, and put them at the two ends of the breastpiece, on its inside edge next to the ephod.

- 27 *And two other rings of gold thou shalt make, and shalt put them on the two sides of the ephod underneath, toward the forepart thereof, over against the other coupling thereof, above the curious girdle of the ephod.* you shall make two rings of gold, and attach them in front to the lower part of the two shoulder pieces of the ephod, at its seam above the skillfully woven band of the ephod.
- 28 *And they shall bind the breastplate by the rings thereof unto the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it may be above the curious girdle of the ephod, and that the breastplate be not loosed from the ephod.* they shall bind the breastpiece by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, so that it may lie on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, so that the breastpiece shall not come loose from the ephod.
- 29 *And Aaron shall bear the names of the children of Israel in the breastplate of judgment upon his heart, when he goeth in unto the holy place, for a memorial before the LORD continually.* So Aaron shall bear the names of the sons of Israel in the breastpiece of judgment on His heart, when He goes into the Holy Place, to bring them to regular remembrance before the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE** Urim (YOOR-im) — "Lights" Sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastpiece. Used by Aaron to seek guidance from God on judicial and national decisions. Always paired with Thummim. Thummim (THUM-im) — "Perfections, completeness" The other of the two sacred objects in the high priest's breastpiece. Exact nature debated — likely stones for yes/no divine consultation.

- 30 *And thou shalt put in the breastplate of judgment the Urim and the Thummim; and they shall be upon Aaron's heart, when he goeth in before the LORD: and Aaron shall bear the judgment of the children of Israel upon his heart before the LORD continually.* in the breastpiece of judgment You shall put the Urim and the Thummim. They shall be on Aaron's heart, when he goes in before the LORD. Thus Aaron shall bear the judgment of the children of Israel on His heart before the LORD regularly.
- 31 *And thou shalt make the robe of the ephod all of blue.* You shall make the robe of the ephod all of blue.

- 32 *And there shall be an hole in the top of it, in the midst thereof: it shall have a binding of woven work round about the hole of it, as it were the hole of an habergeon, that it be not rent.* It shall have an opening for the head in the middle of it, with a woven binding around the opening, like the opening in a garment, so that it may not tear.
- 33 *And beneath upon the hem of it thou shalt make pomegranates of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, round about the hem thereof; and bells of gold between them round about:* On its hem You shall make pomegranates of blue and purple and scarlet yarns, around its hem, with bells of gold between them,
- 34 *A golden bell and a pomegranate, a golden bell and a pomegranate, upon the hem of the robe round about.* a golden bell and a pomegranate, a golden bell and a pomegranate, around the hem of the robe.
- 35 *And it shall be upon Aaron to minister: and his sound shall be heard when he goeth in unto the holy place before the LORD, and when he cometh out, that he die not.* it shall be on Aaron when he ministers, and its sound shall be heard when He goes into the Holy Place before the LORD, and when He comes out, so that He does not die.
- 36 *And thou shalt make a plate of pure gold, and grave upon it, like the engravings of a signet, HOLINESS TO THE LORD.* You shall make a plate of pure gold and engrave on it, like the engraving of a signet, Holy to the LORD.
- 37 *And thou shalt put it on a blue lace, that it may be upon the mitre; upon the forefront of the mitre it shall be.* you shall fasten it on the turban by a cord of blue. It shall be on the front of the turban.
- 38 *And it shall be upon Aaron's forehead, that Aaron may bear the iniquity of the holy things, which the children of Israel shall hallow in all their holy gifts; and it shall be always upon his forehead, that they may be accepted before the LORD.* It shall be on Aaron's forehead, and Aaron shall bear any guilt from the holy things that the children of Israel consecrate as their holy gifts. It shall regularly be on His forehead, that they may be accepted before the LORD.

- 39 *And thou shalt embroider the coat of fine linen, and thou shalt make the mitre of fine linen, and thou shalt make the girdle of needlework.* You shall weave the coat in checker work of fine linen, and You shall make a turban of fine linen, and You shall make a sash embroidered with needlework.
- 40 *And for Aaron's sons thou shalt make coats, and thou shalt make for them girdles, and bonnets shalt thou make for them, for glory and for beauty.* For Aaron's sons you shall make coats and sashes and caps. You shall make them for glory and beauty.
- 41 *And thou shalt put them upon Aaron thy brother, and his sons with him; and shalt anoint them, and consecrate them, and sanctify them, that they may minister unto me in the priest's office.* you shall put them on Aaron your brother, and on his sons with him, and shall anoint them and ordain them and consecrate them, that they may serve me as priests.
- 42 *And thou shalt make them linen breeches to cover their nakedness; from the loins even unto the thighs they shall reach:* You shall make for them linen undergarments to cover their naked flesh. They shall reach from the hips to the thighs;
- 43 *And they shall be upon Aaron, and upon his sons, when they come in unto the tabernacle of the congregation, or when they come near unto the altar to minister in the holy place; that they bear not iniquity, and die: it shall be a statute for ever unto him and his seed after him.* they shall be on Aaron and on his sons when they go into the tent of meeting or when they come near the altar to minister in the Holy Place, lest they bear guilt and die. This shall be a statute forever for him and for his seed after him.

Words in this chapter:

Thummim (*THUM-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate alongside the Urim — together they were God's tool for giving yes/no answers to Israel's leaders.

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

mitre (*MY-ter*) — The turban-like headdress worn by the high priest — a fine linen cap with a gold plate on the front engraved 'HOLINESS TO THE LORD.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Num 18:7; Heb 5:1-5
v2 — Lev 8:30; Ex 31:10; Rev 19:8; Heb 7:26; Job 40:10
v3 — Eph 1:17; 1 Cor 12:7-11; Isa 11:2; Jas 1:17; Ex 31:3-6
v12 — Ex 28:29
v29 — Ex 28:12; Ex 28:30
v30 — Neh 7:65; Ezra 2:63; Num 27:21; Deut 33:8; Lev 8:8
v36 — Lev 8:9; Zech 14:20
v38 — 1 Pet 2:24; Num 18:1; Lev 10:17; Heb 9:28; John 1:29
v40 — Ex 39:41
v41 — Ex 29:7; Lev 8:1-36; Lev 10:7; Ex 40:15; Ex 29:9
v43 — Ex 27:21; Ex 20:26

Chapter 29

The consecration ceremony for Aaron and his sons is described: they are to be washed, clothed in the priestly garments, and anointed; a bull is offered as a sin offering and two rams as a burnt offering and ordination offering over seven days. The LORD commands a continual burnt offering of two lambs daily, one in the morning and one at evening, at the door of the tent of meeting. God promises to sanctify the tabernacle and dwell among the children of Israel and be their God.

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| <p>1 <i>And this is the thing that thou shalt do unto them to hallow them, to minister unto me in the priest's office: Take one young bullock, and two rams without blemish,</i></p> | <p>'Now this is what You shall do to them to consecrate them, that they may serve me as priests. Take one bull of the herd and two rams without blemish,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And unleavened bread, and cakes unleavened tempered with oil, and wafers unleavened anointed with oil: of wheaten flour shalt thou make them.</i></p> | <p>unleavened bread, unleavened cakes mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers smeared with oil. You shall make them of fine wheat flour.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And thou shalt put them into one basket, and bring them in the basket, with the bullock and the two rams.</i></p> | <p>You shall put them in one basket and bring them in the basket, and bring the bull and the two rams.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Aaron and his sons thou shalt bring unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and shalt wash them with water.</i></p> | <p>You shall bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance of the tent of meeting and wash them with water.</p> |

- 5 *And thou shalt take the garments, and put upon Aaron the coat, and the robe of the ephod, and the ephod, and the breastplate, and gird him with the curious girdle of the ephod:* Then you shall take the garments, and put on Aaron the coat and the robe of the ephod, and the ephod, and the breastpiece, and gird him with the skillfully woven band of the ephod.
- 6 *And thou shalt put the mitre upon his head, and put the holy crown upon the mitre.* you shall set the turban on his head and put the holy crown on the turban.
- 7 *Then shalt thou take the anointing oil, and pour it upon his head, and anoint him.* You shall take the anointing oil and pour it on his head and anoint him.
- 8 *And thou shalt bring his sons, and put coats upon them.* Then you shall bring his sons and put coats on them,
- 9 *And thou shalt gird them with girdles, Aaron and his sons, and put the bonnets on them: and the priest's office shall be theirs for a perpetual statute: and thou shalt consecrate Aaron and his sons.* you shall gird Aaron and his sons with sashes and bind caps on them. And the priesthood shall be theirs by a statute forever. Thus you shall ordain Aaron and his sons.
- 10 *And thou shalt cause a bullock to be brought before the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the bullock.* Then you shall bring the bull before the tent of meeting. Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the bull.
- 11 *And thou shalt kill the bullock before the LORD, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* Then You shall kill the bull before the LORD at the entrance of the tent of meeting,
- 12 *And thou shalt take of the blood of the bullock, and put it upon the horns of the altar with thy finger, and pour all the blood beside the bottom of the altar.* shall take part of the blood of the bull and put it on the horns of the altar with Your finger, and the rest of the blood You shall pour out at the base of the altar.

- 13 *And thou shalt take all the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul that is above the liver, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and burn them upon the altar.* you shall take all the fat that covers the entrails, and the long lobe of the liver, and the two kidneys with the fat that is on them, and burn them on the altar.
- 14 *But the flesh of the bullock, and his skin, and his dung, shalt thou burn with fire without the camp: it is a sin offering.* But the flesh of the bull and its skin and its dung You shall burn with fire outside the camp; it is a sin offering.
- 15 *Thou shalt also take one ram; and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the ram.* Then you shall take one of the rams, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the ram,
- 16 *And thou shalt slay the ram, and thou shalt take his blood, and sprinkle it round about upon the altar.* you shall slaughter the ram and shall take its blood and throw it against the sides of the altar.
- 17 *And thou shalt cut the ram in pieces, and wash the inwards of him, and his legs, and put them unto his pieces, and unto his head.* Then you shall cut the ram into pieces, and wash its entrails and its legs, and put them with its pieces and its head,
- 18 *And thou shalt burn the whole ram upon the altar: it is a burnt offering unto the LORD: it is a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* burn the whole ram on the altar. It is a burnt offering to the LORD. It is a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 19 *And thou shalt take the other ram; and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the ram.* You shall take the other ram, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the ram,
- 20 *Then shalt thou kill the ram, and take of his blood, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of Aaron, and upon the tip of the right ear of his sons, and upon the thumb of their right hand, and upon the great toe of their right foot, and sprinkle the blood upon the altar round about.* you shall kill the ram and take part of its blood and put it on the tip of the right ear of Aaron and on the tips of the right ears of his sons, and on the thumbs of their right hands and on the great toes of their right feet, and throw the rest of the blood against the sides of the altar.

- 21 *And thou shalt take of the blood that is upon the altar, and of the anointing oil, and sprinkle it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon the garments of his sons with him: and he shall be hallowed, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons' garments with him.* Then you shall take part of the blood that is on the altar, and of the anointing oil, and sprinkle it on Aaron and his garments, and on his sons and his sons' garments with him. He and his garments shall be holy, and his sons and his sons' garments with him.
- 22 *Also thou shalt take of the ram the fat and the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and the right shoulder; for it is a ram of consecration:* You shall also take the fat from the ram and the fat tail and the fat that covers the entrails, and the long lobe of the liver and the two kidneys with the fat that is on them, and the right thigh (for it is a ram of ordination),
- 23 *And one loaf of bread, and one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer out of the basket of the unleavened bread that is before the LORD:* one loaf of bread and one cake of bread made with oil, and one wafer out of the basket of unleavened bread that is before the LORD.
- 24 *And thou shalt put all in the hands of Aaron, and in the hands of his sons; and shalt wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.* You shall put all these on the palms of Aaron and on the palms of his sons, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.
- 25 *And thou shalt receive them of their hands, and burn them upon the altar for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour before the LORD: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* Then You shall take them from their hands and burn them on the altar on top of the burnt offering, as a sweet savour before the LORD. It is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 26 *And thou shalt take the breast of the ram of Aaron's consecration, and wave it for a wave offering before the LORD: and it shall be thy part.* You shall take the breast of the ram of Aaron's ordination and wave it for a wave offering before the LORD. It shall be Your portion.

- 27 *And thou shalt sanctify the breast of the wave offering, and the shoulder of the heave offering, which is waved, and which is heaved up, of the ram of the consecration, even of that which is for Aaron, and of that which is for his sons:* you shall consecrate the breast of the wave offering that is waved and the thigh of the priests' portion that is contributed from the ram of ordination, from what was Aaron's and his sons'.
- 28 *And it shall be Aaron's and his sons' by a statute for ever from the children of Israel: for it is an heave offering: and it shall be an heave offering from the children of Israel of the sacrifice of their peace offerings, even their heave offering unto the LORD.* It shall be for Aaron and his sons as a perpetual due from the children of Israel, for it is a contribution. It shall be a contribution from the children of Israel from their peace offerings, their contribution to the LORD.
- 29 *And the holy garments of Aaron shall be his sons' after him, to be anointed therein, and to be consecrated in them.* The holy garments of Aaron shall be for his sons after him; they shall be anointed in them and ordained in them.
- 30 *And that son that is priest in his stead shall put them on seven days, when he cometh into the tabernacle of the congregation to minister in the holy place.* The son who succeeds him as priest, who comes into the tent of meeting to minister in the Holy Place, shall wear them seven days.
- 31 *And thou shalt take the ram of the consecration, and seethe his flesh in the holy place.* You shall take the ram of ordination and boil its flesh in a holy place.
- 32 *And Aaron and his sons shall eat the flesh of the ram, and the bread that is in the basket, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* Aaron and his sons shall eat the flesh of the ram and the bread that is in the basket in the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 33 *And they shall eat those things wherewith the atonement was made, to consecrate and to sanctify them: but a stranger shall not eat thereof, because they are holy.* They shall eat those things with which atonement was made at their ordination and consecration, but an outsider shall not eat of them, because they are holy.

- 34 *And if ought of the flesh of the consecrations, or of the bread, remain unto the morning, then thou shalt burn the remainder with fire: it shall not be eaten, because it is holy.* if any of the flesh for the ordination, or of the bread, remain until the morning, then you shall burn the remainder with fire. It shall not be eaten, because it is holy.
- 35 *And thus shalt thou do unto Aaron, and to his sons, according to all things which I have commanded thee: seven days shalt thou consecrate them.* Thus you shall do to Aaron and to his sons, according to all that I have commanded you. Through seven days shall you ordain them,
- 36 *And thou shalt offer every day a bullock for a sin offering for atonement: and thou shalt cleanse the altar, when thou hast made an atonement for it, and thou shalt anoint it, to sanctify it.* every day you shall offer a bull as a sin offering for atonement. Also you shall purify the altar, when you make atonement for it, and shall anoint it to consecrate it.
- 37 *Seven days thou shalt make an atonement for the altar, and sanctify it; and it shall be an altar most holy: whatsoever toucheth the altar shall be holy.* Seven days you shall make atonement for the altar and consecrate it, and the altar shall be most holy. Whatever touches the altar shall become holy.
- 38 *Now this is that which thou shalt offer upon the altar; two lambs of the first year day by day continually.* Now this is what you shall offer on the altar: two lambs a year old day by day regularly.
- 39 *The one lamb thou shalt offer in the morning; and the other lamb thou shalt offer at even:* One lamb you shall offer in the morning, and the other lamb you shall offer at twilight.
- 40 *And with the one lamb a tenth deal of flour mingled with the fourth part of an hin of beaten oil; and the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering.* with the first lamb a tenth measure of fine flour mingled with a fourth of a hin of beaten oil, and a fourth of a hin of wine for a drink offering.

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| <p>41 <i>And the other lamb thou shalt offer at even, and shalt do thereto according to the meat offering of the morning, and according to the drink offering thereof, for a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>42 <i>This shall be a continual burnt offering throughout your generations at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD: where I will meet you, to speak there unto thee.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And there I will meet with the children of Israel, and the tabernacle shall be sanctified by my glory.</i></p> <p>44 <i>And I will sanctify the tabernacle of the congregation, and the altar: I will sanctify also both Aaron and his sons, to minister to me in the priest's office.</i></p> <p>45 <i>And I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will be their God.</i></p> <p>46 <i>And they shall know that I am the LORD their God, that brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, that I may dwell among them: I am the LORD their God.</i></p> | <p>The other lamb You shall offer at twilight, and shall offer with it a grain offering and its drink offering, as in the morning, for a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.</p> <p>It shall be a regular burnt offering throughout Your generations at the entrance of the tent of meeting before the LORD, where I will meet with You, to speak to You there.</p> <p>There I will meet with the children of Israel. It shall be sanctified by my glory.</p> <p>I will consecrate the tent of meeting and the altar. Aaron also and his sons I will consecrate to serve me as priests.</p> <p>I will dwell among the children of Israel and will be their God.</p> <p>they shall know that I am the LORD their God, Who brought them out of the land of Egypt that I might dwell among them. I am the LORD their God.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Ex 40:12; Heb 10:22
- v6 — Lev 8:9
- v7 — Num 35:25; Lev 21:10
- v9 — Num 18:7; Lev 8:22-28

v12 — Ex 27:2

v14 — Lev 4:21; Lev 4:11-12

v18 — Gen 8:21

v36 — Heb 10:11

v38 — Num 28:3-8; 2 Chr 2:4; 1 Chr 16:40

v39 — Ezek 46:13-15

v45 — Lev 26:12; Ex 25:8; 2 Cor 6:16; Zech 2:10; Rev 21:3

v46 — Ex 20:2

Chapter 30

Instructions are given for the golden altar of incense, placed before the veil, where Aaron burns fragrant incense each morning and evening. The LORD commands a half-shekel atonement tax from every man numbered in the census, and describes the bronze basin for washing, the holy anointing oil of myrrh, cinnamon, calamus, cassia, and olive oil, and the sacred incense — all forbidden for common use on pain of being cut off from the people.

- 1 *And thou shalt make an altar to burn incense upon: of shittim wood shalt thou make it.* You shall make an altar on which to burn incense; You shall make it of acacia wood.
- 2 *A cubit shall be the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof; foursquare shall it be: and two cubits shall be the height thereof: the horns thereof shall be of the same.* A cubit shall be its length, and a cubit its breadth. It shall be square, and two cubits shall be its height. Its horns shall be of one piece with it.
- 3 *And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, the top thereof, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns thereof; and thou shalt make unto it a crown of gold round about.* You shall overlay it with pure gold, its top and around its sides and its horns. And You shall make a molding of gold around it.
- 4 *And two golden rings shalt thou make to it under the crown of it, by the two corners thereof, upon the two sides of it shalt thou make it; and they shall be for places for the staves to bear it withal.* you shall make two golden rings for it. Under its molding on two opposite sides of it You shall make them. They shall be holders for poles with which to carry it.
- 5 *And thou shalt make the staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold.* You shall make the poles of acacia wood and overlay them with gold.

- 6 *And thou shalt put it before the vail that is by the ark of the testimony, before the mercy seat that is over the testimony, where I will meet with thee.* you shall put it in front of the veil that is above the ark of the testimony, in front of the mercy seat that is above the testimony, where I will meet with You.
- 7 *And Aaron shall burn thereon sweet incense every morning: when he dresseth the lamps, he shall burn incense upon it.* Aaron shall burn fragrant incense on it. Every morning when he dresses the lamps, he shall burn it,
- 8 *And when Aaron lighteth the lamps at even, he shall burn incense upon it, a perpetual incense before the LORD throughout your generations.* when Aaron sets up the lamps at twilight, he shall burn it, a regular incense offering before the LORD throughout Your generations.
- 9 *Ye shall offer no strange incense thereon, nor burnt sacrifice, nor meat offering; neither shall ye pour drink offering thereon.* You shall not offer unauthorized incense on it, or a burnt offering, or a grain offering, and You shall not pour a drink offering on it.
- 10 *And Aaron shall make an atonement upon the horns of it once in a year with the blood of the sin offering of atonements: once in the year shall he make atonement upon it throughout your generations: it is most holy unto the LORD.* Aaron shall make atonement on its horns once a year. With the blood of the sin offering of atonement He shall make atonement for it once in the year throughout Your generations. It is most holy to the LORD.'
- 11 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD said to Moses,
- 12 *When thou takest the sum of the children of Israel after their number, then shall they give every man a ransom for his soul unto the LORD, when thou numberest them; that there be no plague among them, when thou numberest them.* 'When You take the census of the children of Israel, then each shall give a ransom for His life to the LORD when You number them, that there be no plague among them when You number them.

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| <p>13 <i>This they shall give, every one that passeth among them that are numbered, half a shekel after the shekel of the sanctuary: (a shekel is twenty gerahs:) an half shekel shall be the offering of the LORD.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Every one that passeth among them that are numbered, from twenty years old and above, shall give an offering unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>15 <i>The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less than half a shekel, when they give an offering unto the LORD, to make an atonement for your souls.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And thou shalt take the atonement money of the children of Israel, and shalt appoint it for the service of the tabernacle of the congregation; that it may be for a memorial unto the children of Israel before the LORD, to make an atonement for your souls.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> <p>18 <i>Thou shalt also make a laver of brass, and his foot also of brass, to wash withal: and thou shalt put it between the tabernacle of the congregation and the altar, and thou shalt put water therein.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For Aaron and his sons shall wash their hands and their feet thereat:</i></p> | <p>Each one who is numbered in the census shall give this: half a shekel according to the shekel of the sanctuary (the shekel is twenty gerahs), half a shekel as an offering to the LORD.</p> <p>Everyone who is numbered in the census, from twenty years old and upward, shall give the LORD's offering.</p> <p>The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less, than the half shekel, when You give the LORD's offering to make atonement for Your lives.</p> <p>You shall take the atonement money from the children of Israel and shall give it for the service of the tent of meeting, that it may bring the children of Israel to remembrance before the LORD, so as to make atonement for Your lives.'</p> <p>The LORD said to Moses,</p> <p>'You shall also make a basin of bronze, with its stand of bronze, for washing. You shall put it between the tent of meeting and the altar, and You shall put water in it,</p> <p>with which Aaron and his sons shall wash their hands and their feet.</p> |
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- 20 *When they go into the tabernacle of the congregation, they shall wash with water, that they die not; or when they come near to the altar to minister, to burn offering made by fire unto the LORD:* When they go into the tent of meeting, or when they come near the altar to minister, to burn a offering made by fire to the LORD, they shall wash with water, so that they may not die.
- 21 *So they shall wash their hands and their feet, that they die not: and it shall be a statute for ever to them, even to him and to his seed throughout their generations.* They shall wash their hands and their feet, so that they may not die. It shall be a statute forever to them, even to Him and to His seed throughout their generations.'
- 22 *Moreover the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD said to Moses,
- 23 *Take thou also unto thee principal spices, of pure myrrh five hundred shekels, and of sweet cinnamon half so much, even two hundred and fifty shekels, and of sweet calamus two hundred and fifty shekels,* 'Take the finest spices: of liquid myrrh 500 shekels, and of sweet-smelling cinnamon half as much, that is, 250, and 250 of aromatic cane,
- 24 *And of cassia five hundred shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary, and of oil olive an hin:* 500 of cassia, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, and a hin of olive oil.
- 25 *And thou shalt make it an oil of holy ointment, an ointment compound after the art of the apothecary: it shall be an holy anointing oil.* you shall make of these a sacred anointing oil blended as by the perfumer; it shall be a holy anointing oil.
- 26 *And thou shalt anoint the tabernacle of the congregation therewith, and the ark of the testimony,* With it You shall anoint the tent of meeting and the ark of the testimony,
- 27 *And the table and all his vessels, and the candlestick and his vessels, and the altar of incense,* the table and all its utensils, and the lampstand and its utensils, and the altar of incense,
- 28 *And the altar of burnt offering with all his vessels, and the laver and his foot.* the altar of burnt offering with all its utensils and the basin and its stand.

- 29 *And thou shalt sanctify them, that they may be most holy: whatsoever toucheth them shall be holy.* You shall consecrate them, that they may be most holy. Whatever touches them will become holy.
- 30 *And thou shalt anoint Aaron and his sons, and consecrate them, that they may minister unto me in the priest's office.* You shall anoint Aaron and his sons, and consecrate them, that they may serve me as priests.
- 31 *And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, This shall be an holy anointing oil unto me throughout your generations.* you shall say to the children of Israel, This shall be my holy anointing oil throughout your generations.
- 32 *Upon man's flesh shall it not be poured, neither shall ye make any other like it, after the composition of it: it is holy, and it shall be holy unto you.* It shall not be poured on the body of an ordinary person, and you shall make no other like it in composition. It is holy. It shall be holy to you.
- 33 *Whosoever compoundeth any like it, or whosoever putteth any of it upon a stranger, shall even be cut off from his people.* Whoever compounds any like it or whoever puts any of it on an outsider shall be cut off from his people.'
- 34 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Take unto thee sweet spices, stacte, and onycha, and galbanum; these sweet spices with pure frankincense: of each shall there be a like weight:* The LORD said to Moses, 'Take sweet spices, stacte, and onycha, and galbanum, sweet spices with pure frankincense (of each shall there be an equal part),
- 35 *And thou shalt make it a perfume, a confection after the art of the apothecary, tempered together, pure and holy:* make an incense blended as by the perfumer, seasoned with salt, pure and holy.
- 36 *And thou shalt beat some of it very small, and put of it before the testimony in the tabernacle of the congregation, where I will meet with thee: it shall be unto you most holy.* You shall beat some of it very small, and put part of it before the testimony in the tent of meeting where I shall meet with You. It shall be most holy for You.

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And as for the perfume which thou shalt make, ye shall not make to yourselves according to the composition thereof: it shall be unto thee holy for the LORD.

the incense that You shall make according to its composition, You shall not make for yourselves. It shall be for You holy to the LORD.
- 38

Whosoever shall make like unto it, to smell thereto, shall even be cut off from his people.

Whoever makes any like it to use as perfume shall be cut off from His people.'

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

laver (*LAY-ver*) — The large bronze basin in the tabernacle courtyard — priests washed their hands and feet here before approaching God's altar.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 8:3
- v8 — Heb 9:24
- v9 — Lev 10:1
- v10 — Lev 16:18; Heb 9:22-23
- v12 — Num 31:50; Ex 38:25-26; 1 Pet 1:18-19; 1 Chr 27:24
- v13 — Lev 27:25; Num 3:47
- v18 — Ex 40:7; Ex 38:8
- v19 — Isa 52:11
- v23 — Song 4:14; Ezek 27:19
- v25 — Ex 37:29; 1 Chr 9:30; Ex 40:9; Ps 133:2; Ps 89:20
- v26 — Num 7:1
- v30 — Lev 8:12

Chapter 31

The LORD named Bezaleel of the tribe of Judah and Aholiab of the tribe of Dan as the master craftsmen for building the tabernacle, filling them with the Spirit of God in wisdom, understanding, and skill. The LORD restated the command to keep the Sabbath as a perpetual sign between himself and Israel, declaring that whoever works on it shall be put to death. When he finished speaking with Moses on Sinai, God gave him the two tables of testimony, written with the finger of God.

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And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

The LORD said to Moses,

■ **NAME NOTE** Bezaleel (bez-AL-ee-el) — "In the shadow (protection) of God" Master craftsman of the tabernacle. Grandson of Hur. First person in Scripture said to be filled with the Spirit of God. Also spelled Bezalel. Uri (YOOR-eye) — "My light, fiery" Son of Hur, father of Bezaleel. Of the tribe of Judah.

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| <p>2 See, I have called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah:</p> | <p>'See, I have called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah,</p> |
| <p>3 And I have filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom, and in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all manner of workmanship,</p> | <p>I have filled Him with the Spirit of God, with ability and intelligence, with knowledge and all craftsmanship,</p> |
| <p>4 To devise cunning works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass,</p> | <p>to devise artistic designs, to work in gold, silver, and bronze,</p> |
| <p>5 And in cutting of stones, to set them, and in carving of timber, to work in all manner of workmanship.</p> | <p>in cutting stones for setting, and in carving wood, to work in every craft.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** Aholiab (uh-HO-lih-ab) — "Tent of the father" Master craftsman paired with Bezaleel to build the tabernacle. From the tribe of Dan. Gifted in engraving, designing, embroidery, and weaving. Also spelled Aholiab. Ahisamach (uh-HIS-uh-mak) — "My brother has supported" Father of Aholiab, of the tribe of Dan.

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| <p>6 And I, behold, I have given with him Aholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan: and in the hearts of all that are wise hearted I have put wisdom, that they may make all that I have commanded thee;</p> | <p>I have appointed with Him Aholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan. And I have given to all able men ability, that they may make all that I have commanded You:</p> |
| <p>7 The tabernacle of the congregation, and the ark of the testimony, and the mercy seat that is thereupon, and all the furniture of the tabernacle,</p> | <p>the tent of meeting, and the ark of the testimony, and the mercy seat that is on it. All the furnishings of the tent,</p> |
| <p>8 And the table and his furniture, and the pure candlestick with all his furniture, and the altar of incense,</p> | <p>the table and its utensils, and the pure lampstand with all its utensils, and the altar of incense,</p> |

- 9 *And the altar of burnt offering with all his furniture, and the laver and his foot,* the altar of burnt offering with all its utensils, and the basin and its stand,
- 10 *And the cloths of service, and the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, to minister in the priest's office,* the finely worked garments, the holy garments for Aaron the priest and the garments of his sons, for their service as priests,
- 11 *And the anointing oil, and sweet incense for the holy place: according to all that I have commanded thee shall they do.* the anointing oil and the fragrant incense for the Holy Place. According to all that I have commanded you, they shall do.'
- 12 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD said to Moses,
- 13 *Speak thou also unto the children of Israel, saying, Verily my sabbaths ye shall keep: for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations; that ye may know that I am the LORD that doth sanctify you.* 'You are to speak to the children of Israel and say, Above all You shall keep my Sabbaths, for this is a sign between me and You throughout Your generations, that You may know that I, the LORD, sanctify You.
- 14 *Ye shall keep the sabbath therefore; for it is holy unto you: every one that defileth it shall surely be put to death: for whosoever doeth any work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people.* You shall keep the Sabbath, because it is holy for You. Everyone who profanes it shall be put to death. Whoever does any work on it, that soul shall be cut off from among His people.
- 15 *Six days may work be done; but in the seventh is the sabbath of rest, holy to the LORD: whosoever doeth any work in the sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death.* Six days shall work be done, but the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest, holy to the LORD. Whoever does any work on the Sabbath day shall be put to death.
- 16 *Wherefore the children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant.* Therefore the children of Israel shall keep the Sabbath, observing the Sabbath throughout their generations, as a covenant forever.

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| <p>17 <i>It is a sign between me and the children of Israel for ever: for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he rested, and was refreshed.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And he gave unto Moses, when he had made an end of communing with him upon mount Sinai, two tables of testimony, tables of stone, written with the finger of God.</i></p> | <p>It is a sign forever between me and the children of Israel that in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day He rested and was refreshed.'</p> <p>he gave to Moses, when he had finished speaking with him on Mount Sinai, the two tablets of the testimony, tablets of stone, written with the finger of God.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 35:30; Ex 36:1

v3 — Ex 35:31; Isa 28:26; 1 Cor 12:4-11; 1 Kgs 7:14; Isa 28:6

v6 — Ex 35:10; Ex 28:3; Ex 35:34-36:1

v13 — Ezek 20:12; Ezek 20:20; Lev 19:30; Ex 20:8-11; 1 Thess 5:23

v15 — Gen 2:2; Ex 16:23; Lev 23:3; Ex 34:21

v17 — Gen 1:31; Ex 31:13; Gen 2:2-3; Ezek 20:12; Heb 4:10

v18 — Deut 4:13; Ex 32:15-16; Deut 5:22; Ex 24:12; 2 Cor 3:3

Chapter 32

When Moses delayed on the mountain, the people demanded Aaron make them gods; Aaron collected their gold earrings and fashioned a golden calf, and the people sacrificed to it and rose up to play. The LORD told Moses to go down, and Moses pleaded for the people; descending and seeing the calf and the dancing, he shattered the two tablets in anger. Moses ground the calf to powder, scattered it on the water, and made the people drink it; the sons of Levi killed about three thousand men that day, and the LORD sent a plague upon the people.

- 1 *And when the people saw that Moses delayed to come down out of the mount, the people gathered themselves together unto Aaron, and said unto him, Up, make us gods, which shall go before us; for as for this Moses, the man that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.* When the people saw that Moses delayed to come down from the mountain, the people gathered themselves together to Aaron and said to him, 'Up, make us gods who shall go before us. As for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we do not know what has become of him.'
- 2 *And Aaron said unto them, Break off the golden earrings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them unto me.* So Aaron said to them, 'Take off the rings of gold that are in the ears of your wives, your sons, and your daughters, and bring them to me.'
- 3 *And all the people brake off the golden earrings which were in their ears, and brought them unto Aaron.* So all the people took off the rings of gold that were in their ears and brought them to Aaron.
- 4 *And he received them at their hand, and fashioned it with a graving tool, after he had made it a molten calf: and they said, These be thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.* he received the gold from their hand and fashioned it with a graving tool and made a golden calf. And they said, 'These are your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt!'
- 5 *And when Aaron saw it, he built an altar before it; and Aaron made proclamation, and said, To morrow is a feast to the LORD.* When Aaron saw it, he built an altar before it. And Aaron made a proclamation and said, 'Tomorrow shall be a feast to the LORD.'
- 6 *And they rose up early on the morrow, and offered burnt offerings, and brought peace offerings; and the people sat down to eat and to drink, and rose up to play.* they rose up early the next day and offered burnt offerings and brought peace offerings. And the people sat down to eat and drink and rose up to play.

- 7 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Go, get thee down; for thy people, which thou broughtest out of the land of Egypt, have corrupted themselves:* the LORD said to Moses, 'Go down, for your people, whom you brought up out of the land of Egypt, have corrupted themselves.
- 8 *They have turned aside quickly out of the way which I commanded them: they have made them a molten calf, and have worshipped it, and have sacrificed thereunto, and said, These be thy gods, O Israel, which have brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.* They have turned aside quickly out of the way that I commanded them. They have made for themselves a golden calf and have worshiped it and sacrificed to it and said, These are Your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt.'
- 9 *And the LORD said unto Moses, I have seen this people, and, behold, it is a stiffnecked people:* the LORD said to Moses, 'I have seen this people. It is a stiff-necked people.
- 10 *Now therefore let me alone, that my wrath may wax hot against them, and that I may consume them: and I will make of thee a great nation.* Now therefore let me alone, that my wrath may burn hot against them and I may consume them, in order that I may make a great nation of You.'
- 11 *And Moses besought the LORD his God, and said, LORD, why doth thy wrath wax hot against thy people, which thou hast brought forth out of the land of Egypt with great power, and with a mighty hand?* But Moses implored the LORD His God and said, 'O LORD, why does Your wrath burn hot against Your people, whom You have brought out of the land of Egypt with great power and with a mighty hand?
- 12 *Wherefore should the Egyptians speak, and say, For mischief did he bring them out, to slay them in the mountains, and to consume them from the face of the earth? Turn from thy fierce wrath, and repent of this evil against thy people.* Why should the Egyptians say, With evil intent did He bring them out, to kill them in the mountains and to consume them from the face of the earth? Turn from Your burning anger and relent from this disaster against Your people.

- 13 *Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, thy servants, to whom thou swarest by thine own self, and saidst unto them, I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven, and all this land that I have spoken of will I give unto your seed, and they shall inherit it for ever.* Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, your servants, to whom you swore by your own self, and said to them, I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven, and all this land that I have promised I will give to your seed, and they shall inherit it forever.'
- 14 *And the LORD repented of the evil which he thought to do unto his people.* the LORD relented from the disaster that He had spoken of bringing on His people.
- 15 *And Moses turned, and went down from the mount, and the two tables of the testimony were in his hand: the tables were written on both their sides; on the one side and on the other were they written.* Then Moses turned and went down from the mountain with the two tablets of the testimony in his hand, tablets that were written on both sides; on the front and on the back they were written.
- 16 *And the tables were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, graven upon the tables.* The tablets were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, engraved on the tablets.
- 17 *And when Joshua heard the noise of the people as they shouted, he said unto Moses, There is a noise of war in the camp.* When Joshua heard the noise of the people as they shouted, he said to Moses, 'There is a noise of war in the camp.'
- 18 *And he said, It is not the voice of them that shout for mastery, neither is it the voice of them that cry for being overcome: but the noise of them that sing do I hear.* But he said, 'It is not the sound of shouting for victory, or the sound of the cry of defeat, but the sound of singing that I hear.'
- 19 *And it came to pass, as soon as he came nigh unto the camp, that he saw the calf, and the dancing: and Moses' anger waxed hot, and he cast the tables out of his hands, and brake them beneath the mount.* as soon as he came near the camp and saw the calf and the dancing, Moses' anger burned hot. He threw the tablets out of his hands and broke them at the foot of the mountain.

- 20 *And he took the calf which they had made, and burnt it in the fire, and ground it to powder, and strawed it upon the water, and made the children of Israel drink of it.* He took the calf that they had made and burned it with fire and ground it to powder and scattered it on the water and made the children of Israel drink it.
- 21 *And Moses said unto Aaron, What did this people unto thee, that thou hast brought so great a sin upon them?* Moses said to Aaron, 'What did this people do to you that you have brought such a great sin upon them?'
- 22 *And Aaron said, Let not the anger of my lord wax hot: thou knowest the people, that they are set on mischief.* Aaron said, 'Let not the anger of my lord burn hot. You know the people, that they are set on evil.
- 23 *For they said unto me, Make us gods, which shall go before us: for as for this Moses, the man that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.* For they said to me, Make us gods who shall go before us. As for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we do not know what has become of him.
- 24 *And I said unto them, Whosoever hath any gold, let them break it off. So they gave it me: then I cast it into the fire, and there came out this calf.* So I said to them, Let any who have gold take it off. So they gave it to me. I threw it into the fire, and out came this calf.'
- 25 *And when Moses saw that the people were naked; (for Aaron had made them naked unto their shame among their enemies:)* when Moses saw that the people had broken loose (for Aaron had let them break loose, to the derision of their enemies),
- 26 *Then Moses stood in the gate of the camp, and said, Who is on the LORD's side? let him come unto me. And all the sons of Levi gathered themselves together unto him.* then Moses stood in the gate of the camp and said, 'Who is on the LORD's side? Come to me.' And all the sons of Levi gathered around Him.

- 27 *And he said unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Put every man his sword by his side, and go in and out from gate to gate throughout the camp, and slay every man his brother, and every man his companion, and every man his neighbour.* he said to them, 'Thus says the LORD God of Israel, Put Your sword on Your side each of You, and go to and fro from gate to gate throughout the camp, and each of You kill His brother and His companion and His neighbor.'
- 28 *And the children of Levi did according to the word of Moses: and there fell of the people that day about three thousand men.* the sons of Levi did according to the word of Moses. And that day about three thousand men of the people fell.
- 29 *For Moses had said, Consecrate yourselves to day to the LORD, even every man upon his son, and upon his brother; that he may bestow upon you a blessing this day.* Moses said, 'Today you have been ordained for the service of the LORD, each one at the cost of his son and of his brother, so that He might bestow a blessing upon You this day.'
- 30 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses said unto the people, Ye have sinned a great sin: and now I will go up unto the LORD; peradventure I shall make an atonement for your sin.* The next day Moses said to the people, 'You have sinned a great sin. And now I will go up to the LORD; perhaps I can make atonement for Your sin.'
- 31 *And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, Oh, this people have sinned a great sin, and have made them gods of gold.* So Moses returned to the LORD and said, 'Alas, this people has sinned a great sin. They have made for themselves gods of gold.
- 32 *Yet now, if thou wilt forgive their sin; and if not, blot me, I pray thee, out of thy book which thou hast written.* But now, if You will forgive their sin — but if not, please blot me out of Your book that You have written.'
- 33 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Whosoever hath sinned against me, him will I blot out of my book.* But the LORD said to Moses, 'Whoever has sinned against me, I will blot out of my book.'

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| <p>34 <i>Therefore now go, lead the people unto the place of which I have spoken unto thee: behold, mine Angel shall go before thee: nevertheless in the day when I visit I will visit their sin upon them.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And the LORD plagued the people, because they made the calf, which Aaron made.</i></p> | <p>But now go, lead the people to the place about which I have spoken to You; my angel shall go before You. Nevertheless, in the day when I visit, I will visit their sin upon them.'</p> <p>Then the LORD sent a plague on the people, because they made the calf, the one that Aaron made.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Acts 7:40; Deut 9:9; Matt 24:48; 2 Pet 3:4; Ex 24:18
- v4** — Neh 9:18; Acts 7:41; Deut 9:16; 1 Kgs 12:28; Ex 32:5
- v6** — 1 Cor 10:7; Num 25:2
- v8** — 1 Kgs 12:28; Ex 20:3-4; Ex 20:23
- v9** — Acts 7:51; Isa 48:4; Deut 9:13; Ex 34:9; Ex 33:5
- v10** — Deut 9:14; Num 14:12; Deut 9:19; Num 16:45-48
- v12** — Num 14:13-16; Deut 9:28
- v13** — Heb 6:13; Gen 22:16; Gen 12:7; Gen 15:5; Gen 15:18
- v14** — Jonah 3:10; Jer 26:13; Ps 106:45; 1 Chr 21:15
- v26** — 2 Kgs 9:32; Matt 12:30
- v32** — Ps 69:28; Rom 9:3; Phil 4:3; Rev 21:27; Dan 12:1
- v33** — Deut 29:20; Ezek 18:4; Rev 20:12; Ps 69:28; Ps 9:5

Chapter 33

The LORD commanded Israel to depart for the Promised Land but said he would not go up in their midst lest he consume them, for they were a stiff-necked people; the people mourned and stripped off their ornaments. Moses pitched the tent of meeting outside the camp, and the pillar of cloud descended when he entered; the LORD spoke to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. Moses asked to see God's glory, and the LORD agreed to pass by and proclaim his name, but said no man could see his face and live, placing Moses in the cleft of a rock and covering him with his hand.

- 1 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Depart, and go up hence, thou and the people which thou hast brought up out of the land of Egypt, unto the land which I sware unto Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, saying, Unto thy seed will I give it:* The LORD said to Moses, 'Depart; go up from here, you and the people whom you have brought up out of the land of Egypt, to the land of which I swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying, To your seed I will give it.
- 2 *And I will send an angel before thee; and I will drive out the Canaanite, the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite:* I will send an angel before You. I will drive out the Canaanites, the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites.
- 3 *Unto a land flowing with milk and honey: for I will not go up in the midst of thee; for thou art a stiffnecked people: lest I consume thee in the way.* Go up to a land flowing with milk and honey; but I will not go up among You, lest I consume You on the way, for You are a stiff-necked people.'
- 4 *And when the people heard these evil tidings, they mourned: and no man did put on him his ornaments.* When the people heard this disastrous word, they mourned, and no one put on his ornaments.
- 5 *For the LORD had said unto Moses, Say unto the children of Israel, Ye are a stiffnecked people: I will come up into the midst of thee in a moment, and consume thee: therefore now put off thy ornaments from thee, that I may know what to do unto thee.* For the LORD had said to Moses, 'Say to the children of Israel, you are a stiff-necked people; if for a single moment I should go up among you, I would consume you. So now take off your ornaments, that I may know what to do with you.'
- 6 *And the children of Israel stripped themselves of their ornaments by the mount Horeb.* Therefore the children of Israel stripped themselves of their ornaments, from Mount Horeb onward.

- 7 *And Moses took the tabernacle, and pitched it without the camp, afar off from the camp, and called it the Tabernacle of the congregation. And it came to pass, that every one which sought the LORD went out unto the tabernacle of the congregation, which was without the camp.* Now Moses used to take the tent and pitch it outside the camp, far off from the camp. He called it the tent of meeting. And everyone who sought the LORD would go out to the tent of meeting, which was outside the camp.
- 8 *And it came to pass, when Moses went out unto the tabernacle, that all the people rose up, and stood every man at his tent door, and looked after Moses, until he was gone into the tabernacle.* Whenever Moses went out to the tent, all the people would rise up, and each would stand at his tent door, and watch Moses until he had gone into the tent.
- 9 *And it came to pass, as Moses entered into the tabernacle, the cloudy pillar descended, and stood at the door of the tabernacle, and the Lord talked with Moses.* When Moses entered the tent, the pillar of cloud would descend and stand at the entrance of the tent. The LORD would speak with Moses.
- 10 *And all the people saw the cloudy pillar stand at the tabernacle door: and all the people rose up and worshipped, every man in his tent door.* when all the people saw the pillar of cloud standing at the entrance of the tent, all the people would rise up and worship, each at his tent door.
- **NAME NOTE** Nun (NUN) — "Fish, posterity" Father of Joshua. Of the tribe of Ephraim.
- 11 *And the LORD spake unto Moses face to face, as a man speaketh unto his friend. And he turned again into the camp: but his servant Joshua, the son of Nun, a young man, departed not out of the tabernacle.* Thus the LORD used to speak to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. When Moses turned again into the camp, his assistant Joshua the son of Nun, a young man, would not depart from the tent.

- 12 *And Moses said unto the LORD, See, thou sayest unto me, Bring up this people: and thou hast not let me know whom thou wilt send with me. Yet thou hast said, I know thee by name, and thou hast also found grace in my sight.* Moses said to the LORD, 'See, You say to me, Bring up this people, but You have not let me know whom You will send with me. Yet You have said, I know You by name, and You have also found favor in my sight.
- 13 *Now therefore, I pray thee, if I have found grace in thy sight, shew me now thy way, that I may know thee, that I may find grace in thy sight: and consider that this nation is thy people.* Now therefore, if I have found favor in Your sight, please show me now Your ways, that I may know You in order to find favor in Your sight. Consider too that this nation is Your people.'
- 14 *And he said, My presence shall go with thee, and I will give thee rest.* he said, 'My presence will go with You. I will give You rest.'
- 15 *And he said unto him, If thy presence go not with me, carry us not up hence.* he said to Him, 'If Your presence will not go with me, do not bring us up from here.
- 16 *For wherein shall it be known here that I and thy people have found grace in thy sight? is it not in that thou goest with us? so shall we be separated, I and thy people, from all the people that are upon the face of the earth.* For how shall it be known that I have found favor in Your sight, I and Your people? Is it not in Your going with us, so that we are distinct, I and Your people, from every other people on the face of the earth?'
- 17 *And the LORD said unto Moses, I will do this thing also that thou hast spoken: for thou hast found grace in my sight, and I know thee by name.* the LORD said to Moses, 'This very thing that you have spoken I will do, for you have found favor in my sight. I know you by name.'
- 18 *And he said, I beseech thee, shew me thy glory.* Moses said, 'Please show me your glory.'

- 19 *And he said, I will make all my goodness pass before thee, and I will proclaim the name of the LORD before thee; and will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will shew mercy on whom I will shew mercy.* he said, 'I will make all my goodness pass before You and will proclaim before You my name, The LORD. And I will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will show mercy on whom I will show mercy.
- 20 *And he said, Thou canst not see my face: for there shall no man see me, and live.* But,' he said, 'you cannot see my face, for man shall not see me and live.'
- 21 *And the LORD said, Behold, there is a place by me, and thou shalt stand upon a rock:* the LORD said, ' there is a place by me where You shall stand on the rock,
- 22 *And it shall come to pass, while my glory passeth by, that I will put thee in a cleft of the rock, and will cover thee with my hand while I pass by:* while my glory passes by I will put You in a cleft of the rock. I will cover You with my hand until I have passed by.
- 23 *And I will take away mine hand, and thou shalt see my back parts: but my face shall not be seen.* Then I will take away my hand, and You shall see my back, but my face shall not be seen.'

Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Ex 32:9-10; Deut 9:6-13; Acts 7:51; Ex 3:8
- v11 — Num 12:8; Deut 34:10; Ex 24:13; Ex 33:9; Deut 5:4
- v12 — Ex 33:17; Jer 1:5; John 10:14-15; 2 Tim 2:19; Ex 32:34
- v13 — Ps 119:33; Ps 25:4; Ps 27:11; Ps 86:11; Deut 9:26
- v14 — Matt 11:28; Josh 21:44; Josh 1:5; Isa 63:9; Heb 4:8-9
- v15 — Ex 34:9; Ps 4:6; Ex 33:3
- v16 — Deut 4:7; Num 14:14; Matt 1:23; 1 Kgs 8:53; Ex 34:10
- v17 — Isa 65:24; 1 John 5:14-15; Ex 33:12
- v18 — Rev 21:23; Titus 2:13; Ex 33:20; 1 Tim 6:16; 2 Cor 4:6
- v19 — Rom 9:15-18; Eph 1:6-8; Jer 31:14; Jer 31:12; Ex 34:5-7
- v20 — John 1:18; Gen 32:30; 1 Tim 6:16; Isa 6:5; Judg 13:22
- v22 — Ps 91:1; Isa 2:21; Ps 91:4; 1 Cor 10:4; Ps 18:2

Chapter 34

The LORD told Moses to cut two new tablets of stone and come up to Sinai alone; the LORD descended in a cloud and proclaimed his name: "The LORD, The LORD God, merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth." God renewed the covenant, warning against idolatry and intermarriage with the Canaanites, and restating the feasts and the Sabbath. Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights without food or water; when he came down, the skin of his face shone so brightly that the people were afraid to come near him, and he put a veil over his face.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the first: and I will write upon these tables the words that were in the first tables, which thou brakest.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Moses, 'Cut for yourself two tablets of stone like the first. I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And be ready in the morning, and come up in the morning unto mount Sinai, and present thyself there to me in the top of the mount.</i></p> | <p>Be ready by the morning, and come up in the morning to Mount Sinai, and present Yourself there to me on the top of the mountain.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And no man shall come up with thee, neither let any man be seen throughout all the mount; neither let the flocks nor herds feed before that mount.</i></p> | <p>No one shall come up with you, and let no one be seen throughout all the mountain. Let no flocks or herds graze opposite that mountain.'</p> |

- 4 *And he hewed two tables of stone like unto the first; and Moses rose up early in the morning, and went up unto mount Sinai, as the LORD had commanded him, and took in his hand the two tables of stone.* So Moses cut two tablets of stone like the first. And He rose early in the morning and went up on Mount Sinai, as the LORD had commanded Him, and took in His hand two tablets of stone.
- 5 *And the LORD descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed the name of the LORD.* The LORD descended in the cloud and stood with Him there, and proclaimed the name of the LORD.
- 6 *And the LORD passed by before him, and proclaimed, The LORD, The LORD God, merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth,* The LORD passed before Him and proclaimed, 'The LORD, the LORD, a God merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and of great mercy and truth,
- 7 *Keeping mercy for thousands, forgiving iniquity and transgression and sin, and that will by no means clear the guilty; visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children, and upon the children's children, unto the third and to the fourth generation.* keeping mercy for thousands, forgiving iniquity and transgression and sin, but who will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children and the children's children, to the third and the fourth generation.'
- 8 *And Moses made haste, and bowed his head toward the earth, and worshipped.* Moses quickly bowed his head toward the earth and worshiped.
- 9 *And he said, If now I have found grace in thy sight, O LORD, let my LORD, I pray thee, go among us; for it is a stiffnecked people; and pardon our iniquity and our sin, and take us for thine inheritance.* he said, 'If now I have found favor in your sight, O Lord, please let the Lord go in the midst of us, for it is a stiff-necked people, and pardon our iniquity and our sin, and take us for your inheritance.'

- 10 *And he said, Behold, I make a covenant: before all thy people I will do marvels, such as have not been done in all the earth, nor in any nation: and all the people among which thou art shall see the work of the LORD: for it is a terrible thing that I will do with thee.* he said, ' I am making a covenant. Before all Your people I will do marvels, such as have not been created in all the earth or in any nation. And all the people among whom you are shall see the work of the LORD, for it is an awesome thing that I will do with You.
- 11 *Observe thou that which I command thee this day: behold, I drive out before thee the Amorite, and the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite.* Observe what I command You this day. I will drive out before You the Amorites, the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites.
- 12 *Take heed to thyself, lest thou make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land whither thou goest, lest it be for a snare in the midst of thee:* Take care, lest You make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land to which You go, lest it become a snare in Your midst.
- 13 *But ye shall destroy their altars, break their images, and cut down their groves:* You shall tear down their altars and break their pillars and cut down their groves
- 14 *For thou shalt worship no other god: for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God:* (for You shall worship no other god, for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God),
- 15 *Lest thou make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land, and they go a whoring after their gods, and do sacrifice unto their gods, and one call thee, and thou eat of his sacrifice;* lest You make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land, and when they whore after their gods and sacrifice to their gods and You are invited, You eat of His sacrifice,
- 16 *And thou take of their daughters unto thy sons, and their daughters go a whoring after their gods, and make thy sons go a whoring after their gods.* you take of their daughters for Your sons. Their daughters whore after their gods and make Your sons whore after their gods.

- 17 *Thou shalt make thee no molten gods.* You shall not make for Yourself any gods of cast metal.
- 18 *The feast of unleavened bread shalt thou keep. Seven days thou shalt eat unleavened bread, as I commanded thee, in the time of the month Abib: for in the month Abib thou camest out from Egypt.* You shall keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread. Seven days You shall eat unleavened bread, as I commanded You, at the appointed time in the month of Abib, for in the month of Abib You came out of Egypt.
- 19 *All that openeth the matrix is mine; and every firstling among thy cattle, whether ox or sheep, that is male.* All that open the womb are mine, all Your male livestock, the firstborn of cow and sheep.
- 20 *But the firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb: and if thou redeem him not, then shalt thou break his neck. All the firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem. And none shall appear before me empty.* The firstborn of a donkey You shall redeem with a lamb, or if You will not redeem it You shall break its neck. All the firstborn of Your sons You shall redeem. And none shall appear before me empty-handed.
- 21 *Six days thou shalt work, but on the seventh day thou shalt rest: in earing time and in harvest thou shalt rest.* Six days You shall work, but on the seventh day You shall rest. In plowing time and in harvest You shall rest.
- 22 *And thou shalt observe the feast of weeks, of the firstfruits of wheat harvest, and the feast of ingathering at the year's end.* You shall observe the Feast of Weeks, the firstfruits of wheat harvest, and the Feast of Ingathering at the year's end.
- 23 *Thrice in the year shall all your men children appear before the Lord GOD, the God of Israel.* Three times in the year shall all Your males appear before the Lord GOD, the God of Israel.
- 24 *For I will cast out the nations before thee, and enlarge thy borders: neither shall any man desire thy land, when thou shalt go up to appear before the LORD thy God thrice in the year.* For I will cast out nations before You and enlarge Your borders; no one shall covet your land when you go up to appear before the LORD Your God three times in the year.

- 25 *Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leaven; neither shall the sacrifice of the feast of the passover be left unto the morning.* You shall not offer the blood of my sacrifice with anything leavened, or let the sacrifice of the Feast of the Passover remain until the morning.
- 26 *The first of the firstfruits of thy land thou shalt bring unto the house of the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother's milk.* The best of the firstfruits of Your ground You shall bring to the house of the LORD Your God. You shall not boil a young goat in its mother's milk.'
- 27 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Write thou these words: for after the tenor of these words I have made a covenant with thee and with Israel.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Write these words, for in accordance with these words I have made a covenant with you and with Israel.'
- 28 *And he was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights; he did neither eat bread, nor drink water. And he wrote upon the tables the words of the covenant, the ten commandments.* So He was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights. He neither ate bread nor drank water. And He wrote on the tablets the words of the covenant, the Ten Commandments.
- 29 *And it came to pass, when Moses came down from mount Sinai with the two tables of testimony in Moses' hand, when he came down from the mount, that Moses wist not that the skin of his face shone while he talked with him.* When Moses came down from Mount Sinai, with the two tablets of the testimony in his hand as he came down from the mountain, Moses did not know that the skin of his face shone because he had been talking with God.
- 30 *And when Aaron and all the children of Israel saw Moses, behold, the skin of his face shone; and they were afraid to come nigh him.* Aaron and all the children of Israel saw Moses, and the skin of his face shone. They were afraid to come near him.
- 31 *And Moses called unto them; and Aaron and all the rulers of the congregation returned unto him: and Moses talked with them.* But Moses called to them, and Aaron and all the leaders of the congregation returned to him, and Moses talked with them.

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| <p>32 <i>And afterward all the children of Israel came nigh: and he gave them in commandment all that the LORD had spoken with him in mount Sinai.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And till Moses had done speaking with them, he put a vail on his face.</i></p> <p>34 <i>But when Moses went in before the LORD to speak with him, he took the vail off, until he came out. And he came out, and spake unto the children of Israel that which he was commanded.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And the children of Israel saw the face of Moses, that the skin of Moses' face shone: and Moses put the vail upon his face again, until he went in to speak with him.</i></p> | <p>Afterward all the children of Israel came near. He commanded them all that the LORD had spoken with Him in Mount Sinai.</p> <p>when Moses had finished speaking with them, he put a veil over his face.</p> <p>Whenever Moses went in before the LORD to speak with Him, He would remove the veil, until He came out. And when He came out and told the children of Israel what He was commanded,</p> <p>the children of Israel would see the face of Moses, that the skin of Moses' face was shining. And Moses would put the veil over his face again, until he went in to speak with him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 32:19; Ex 31:18; Deut 10:1-4; Ps 119:89; Ex 34:28
- v5 — Ex 33:19; Ex 33:9; Luke 9:34-35; Num 11:25; Num 11:17
- v6 — Ps 86:15; Joel 2:13; Ps 103:8-13; Ps 145:8; Neh 9:17
- v7 — Ex 20:5-6; Ps 103:3; Deut 5:9-10; Eph 1:7; Num 14:18-23
- v9 — Ps 33:12; Ps 94:14; Deut 32:9; Ex 33:13-17; Ps 135:4
- v10 — Deut 10:21; Ps 77:14; Isa 64:3; Ps 66:5; Jer 32:21
- v14 — Deut 4:24; Deut 32:21; 1 Cor 10:22; Matt 4:10; Ex 20:3-5
- v15 — Judg 2:17; Deut 31:16; Ps 106:28; Num 25:2; 1 Cor 8:4
- v16 — Ezra 9:2; Deut 7:3-4; 1 Kgs 11:2-4; Num 25:1-2; Neh 13:25
- v24 — Ps 78:55; Ex 33:2; Acts 18:10; 1 Chr 4:10; Prov 16:7
- v28 — Ex 34:1; Deut 4:13; Ex 24:18; Deut 9:25; Deut 9:18
- v29 — Matt 17:2; Luke 9:29; Ex 32:15; Rev 1:16; 2 Cor 3:13

Chapter 35

Moses assembled the congregation and restated the command to keep the Sabbath, then called for a freewill offering of materials for the tabernacle — gold, silver, bronze, fabrics, skins, wood, oil, spices, and stones. The people brought willingly, and Moses identified Bezaleel and Aholiab as the craftsmen God had filled with his Spirit to design and build the tabernacle and all its furnishings.

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| <p>1 <i>And Moses gathered all the congregation of the children of Israel together, and said unto them, These are the words which the LORD hath commanded, that ye should do them.</i></p> | <p>Moses assembled all the congregation of the children of Israel and said to them, 'These are the things that the LORD has commanded You to do.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be to you an holy day, a sabbath of rest to the LORD: whosoever doeth work therein shall be put to death.</i></p> | <p>Six days work shall be done, but on the seventh day You shall have a Sabbath of solemn rest, holy to the LORD. Whoever does any work on it shall be put to death.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Ye shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations upon the sabbath day.</i></p> | <p>You shall kindle no fire in all Your dwelling places on the Sabbath day.'</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Moses spake unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, This is the thing which the LORD commanded, saying,</i></p> | <p>Moses said to all the congregation of the children of Israel, 'This is the thing that the LORD has commanded.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Take ye from among you an offering unto the LORD: whosoever is of a willing heart, let him bring it, an offering of the LORD; gold, and silver, and brass,</i></p> | <p>Take from among You a contribution to the LORD. Whoever is of a generous heart, let him bring the LORD's contribution: gold, silver, and bronze;</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair,</i></p> | <p>blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine linen; goats' hair,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And rams' skins dyed red, and badgers' skins, and shittim wood,</i></p> | <p>tanned rams' skins, and goatskins; acacia wood,</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And oil for the light, and spices for anointing oil, and for the sweet incense,</i></p> | <p>oil for the light, and spices for the anointing oil and for the fragrant incense,</p> |

- 9 *And onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod, and for the breastplate.* onyx stones and stones for setting, for the ephod and for the breastpiece.
- 10 *And every wise hearted among you shall come, and make all that the LORD hath commanded;* Let every skillful craftsman among You come and make all that the LORD has commanded:
- 11 *The tabernacle, his tent, and his covering, his taches, and his boards, his bars, his pillars, and his sockets,* the tabernacle, its tent and its covering, its hooks and its frames, its bars, its pillars, and its bases;
- 12 *The ark, and the staves thereof, with the mercy seat, and the vail of the covering,* the ark with its poles, the mercy seat, and the veil of the screen;
- 13 *The table, and his staves, and all his vessels, and the shewbread,* the table with its poles and all its utensils, and the bread of the Presence;
- 14 *The candlestick also for the light, and his furniture, and his lamps, with the oil for the light,* the lampstand also for the light, with its utensils and its lamps, and the oil for the light;
- 15 *And the incense altar, and his staves, and the anointing oil, and the sweet incense, and the hanging for the door at the entering in of the tabernacle,* the altar of incense, with its poles, and the anointing oil and the fragrant incense, and the screen for the door, at the door of the tabernacle;
- 16 *The altar of burnt offering, with his brasen grate, his staves, and all his vessels, the laver and his foot,* the altar of burnt offering, with its grating of bronze, its poles. All its utensils, the basin and its stand;
- 17 *The hangings of the court, his pillars, and their sockets, and the hanging for the door of the court,* the hangings of the court, its pillars and its bases, and the screen for the gate of the court;
- 18 *The pins of the tabernacle, and the pins of the court, and their cords,* the pegs of the tabernacle and the pegs of the court, and their cords,
- 19 *The cloths of service, to do service in the holy place, the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, to minister in the priest's office.* the finely worked garments for ministering in the Holy Place, the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, for their service as priests.'

- 20 *And all the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses.* Then all the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses.
- 21 *And they came, every one whose heart stirred him up, and every one whom his spirit made willing, and they brought the LORD's offering to the work of the tabernacle of the congregation, and for all his service, and for the holy garments.* they came, everyone whose heart stirred Him, and everyone whose spirit moved Him, and brought the LORD's contribution to be used for the tent of meeting, and for all its service, and for the holy garments.
- 22 *And they came, both men and women, as many as were willing hearted, and brought bracelets, and earrings, and rings, and tablets, all jewels of gold: and every man that offered offered an offering of gold unto the LORD.* So they came, both men and women. All who were of a willing heart brought brooches and earrings and signet rings and armlets, all sorts of gold objects, every man dedicating an offering of gold to the LORD.
- 23 *And every man, with whom was found blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair, and red skins of rams, and badgers' skins, brought them.* every one who possessed blue or purple or scarlet yarns or fine linen or goats' hair or tanned rams' skins or goatskins brought them.
- 24 *Every one that did offer an offering of silver and brass brought the LORD's offering: and every man, with whom was found shittim wood for any work of the service, brought it.* Everyone who could make a contribution of silver or bronze brought it as the LORD's contribution. And every one who possessed acacia wood of any use in the work brought it.
- 25 *And all the women that were wise hearted did spin with their hands, and brought that which they had spun, both of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, and of fine linen.* every skillful woman spun with her hands. They all brought what they had spun in blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen.
- 26 *And all the women whose heart stirred them up in wisdom spun goats' hair.* All the women whose hearts stirred them to use their skill spun the goats' hair.

- 27 *And the rulers brought onyx stones, and stones to be set, for the ephod, and for the breastplate;* the leaders brought onyx stones and stones to be set, for the ephod and for the breastpiece,
- 28 *And spice, and oil for the light, and for the anointing oil, and for the sweet incense.* spices and oil for the light, and for the anointing oil, and for the fragrant incense.
- 29 *The children of Israel brought a willing offering unto the LORD, every man and woman, whose heart made them willing to bring for all manner of work, which the LORD had commanded to be made by the hand of Moses.* All the men and women, the children of Israel, whose heart moved them to bring anything for the work that the LORD had commanded by Moses to be done brought it as a freewill offering to the LORD.
- 30 *And Moses said unto the children of Israel, See, the LORD hath called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah;* Then Moses said to the children of Israel, 'See, the LORD has called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah;
- 31 *And he hath filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom, in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all manner of workmanship;* he has filled Him with the Spirit of God, with skill, with intelligence, with knowledge, and with all craftsmanship,
- 32 *And to devise curious works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass,* to devise artistic designs, to work in gold and silver and bronze,
- 33 *And in the cutting of stones, to set them, and in carving of wood, to make any manner of cunning work.* in cutting stones for setting, and in carving wood, for work in every skilled craft.
- 34 *And he hath put in his heart that he may teach, both he, and Aholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan.* he has inspired Him to teach, both Him and Aholiab the son of Ahisamach of the tribe of Dan.

- 35 *Them hath he filled with wisdom of heart, to work all manner of work, of the engraver, and of the cunning workman, and of the embroiderer, in blue, and in purple, in scarlet, and in fine linen, and of the weaver, even of them that do any work, and of those that devise cunning work.*
- He has filled them with skill to do every sort of work done by an engraver or by a designer or by an embroiderer in blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen, or by a weaver — by any sort of workman or skilled designer.

Words in this chapter:

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 34:32
 v2 — Lev 23:3; Luke 13:14-15
 v3 — Ex 16:23
 v4 — Ex 25:1-2
 v5 — 2 Cor 9:7; Ps 110:3; Ex 25:2-7
 v13 — Ex 25:23-30
 v16 — Ex 27:1-8
 v21 — Ex 25:2; 1 Chr 29:14; Ex 35:29; Ex 35:26
 v26 — Ex 35:21; Ex 35:29; Ex 36:8
 v27 — 1 Chr 29:6; Ezra 2:68
 v29 — 2 Cor 9:7
 v35 — Ex 35:31; 1 Kgs 7:14; Isa 28:26

Chapter 36

The craftsmen began building the tabernacle, and the people brought so much material that Moses had to command them to stop giving. The construction of the tabernacle's ten inner curtains of fine linen, the eleven curtains of goat hair, the coverings of ram skins and goatskins, and the boards of acacia wood with their silver sockets is described in detail, matching the pattern God had shown Moses on the mountain.

- 1 *Then wrought Bezaleel and Aholiab, and every wise hearted man, in whom the LORD put wisdom and understanding to know how to work all manner of work for the service of the sanctuary, according to all that the LORD had commanded.* 'Bezaleel and Aholiab and every craftsman in whom the LORD has put skill and intelligence to know how to do any work in the construction of the sanctuary shall work in accordance with all that the LORD has commanded.'
- 2 *And Moses called Bezaleel and Aholiab, and every wise hearted man, in whose heart the LORD had put wisdom, even every one whose heart stirred him up to come unto the work to do it:* Moses called Bezaleel and Aholiab and every craftsman in whose heart the LORD had put skill, everyone whose heart stirred Him up to come to do the work.
- 3 *And they received of Moses all the offering, which the children of Israel had brought for the work of the service of the sanctuary, to make it withal. And they brought yet unto him free offerings every morning.* they received from Moses all the contribution that the children of Israel had brought for doing the work on the sanctuary. They still kept bringing him freewill offerings every morning,
- 4 *And all the wise men, that wrought all the work of the sanctuary, came every man from his work which they made;* so that all the craftsmen who were doing every sort of task on the sanctuary came, each from the task that he was doing,
- 5 *And they spake unto Moses, saying, The people bring much more than enough for the service of the work, which the LORD commanded to make.* said to Moses, 'The people bring much more than enough for doing the work that the LORD has commanded us to do.'
- 6 *And Moses gave commandment, and they caused it to be proclaimed throughout the camp, saying, Let neither man nor woman make any more work for the offering of the sanctuary. So the people were restrained from bringing.* So Moses gave command, and word was proclaimed throughout the camp, 'Let no man or woman do anything more for the contribution for the sanctuary.' So the people were restrained from bringing,

- 7 *For the stuff they had was sufficient for all the work to make it, and too much.* for the material they had was sufficient to do all the work, and more.
- 8 *And every wise hearted man among them that wrought the work of the tabernacle made ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet: with cherubims of cunning work made he them.* all the craftsmen among the workmen made the tabernacle with ten curtains. They were made of fine twined linen and blue and purple and scarlet yarns, with cherubim skillfully worked.
- 9 *The length of one curtain was twenty and eight cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: the curtains were all of one size.* The length of each curtain was 28 cubits, and the breadth of each curtain 4 cubits. All the curtains were the same size.
- 10 *And he coupled the five curtains one unto another: and the other five curtains he coupled one unto another.* He coupled five curtains to one another, and the other five curtains he coupled to one another.
- 11 *And he made loops of blue on the edge of one curtain from the selvedge in the coupling: likewise he made in the uttermost side of another curtain, in the coupling of the second.* He made loops of blue on the edge of the outermost curtain of the first set. Likewise he made them on the edge of the outermost curtain of the second set.
- 12 *Fifty loops made he in one curtain, and fifty loops made he in the edge of the curtain which was in the coupling of the second: the loops held one curtain to another.* He made fifty loops on the one curtain. He made fifty loops on the edge of the curtain that was in the second set. The loops were opposite one another.
- 13 *And he made fifty taches of gold, and coupled the curtains one unto another with the taches: so it became one tabernacle.* he made fifty clasps of gold, and coupled the curtains one to the other with clasps. So the tabernacle was a single whole.
- 14 *And he made curtains of goats' hair for the tent over the tabernacle: eleven curtains he made them.* He also made curtains of goats' hair for a tent over the tabernacle; he made eleven curtains.

- 15 *The length of one curtain was thirty cubits, and four cubits was the breadth of one curtain: the eleven curtains were of one size.* The length of each curtain was 30 cubits, and the breadth of each curtain 4 cubits. The eleven curtains were the same size.
- 16 *And he coupled five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves.* He coupled five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves.
- 17 *And he made fifty loops upon the uttermost edge of the curtain in the coupling, and fifty loops made he upon the edge of the curtain which coupleth the second.* he made fifty loops on the edge of the outermost curtain of the one set, and fifty loops on the edge of the other connecting curtain.
- 18 *And he made fifty taches of brass to couple the tent together, that it might be one.* he made fifty clasps of bronze to couple the tent together that it might be a single whole.
- 19 *And he made a covering for the tent of rams' skins dyed red, and a covering of badgers' skins above that.* he made for the tent a covering of tanned rams' skins and goatskins.
- 20 *And he made boards for the tabernacle of shittim wood, standing up.* Then he made the upright frames for the tabernacle of acacia wood.
- 21 *The length of a board was ten cubits, and the breadth of a board one cubit and a half.* Ten cubits was the length of a frame, and a cubit and a half the breadth of each frame.
- 22 *One board had two tenons, equally distant one from another: thus did he make for all the boards of the tabernacle.* Each frame had two tenons for fitting together. He did this for all the frames of the tabernacle.
- 23 *And he made boards for the tabernacle; twenty boards for the south side southward:* The frames for the tabernacle he made thus: twenty frames for the south side.

- 24 *And forty sockets of silver he made under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for his two tenons, and two sockets under another board for his two tenons.* he made forty bases of silver under the twenty frames, two bases under one frame for its two tenons, and two bases under the next frame for its two tenons.
- 25 *And for the other side of the tabernacle, which is toward the north corner, he made twenty boards,* For the second side of the tabernacle, on the north side, he made twenty frames
- 26 *And their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.* their forty bases of silver, two bases under one frame and two bases under the next frame.
- 27 *And for the sides of the tabernacle westward he made six boards.* For the rear of the tabernacle westward he made six frames.
- 28 *And two boards made he for the corners of the tabernacle in the two sides.* He made two frames for corners of the tabernacle in the rear.
- 29 *And they were coupled beneath, and coupled together at the head thereof, to one ring: thus he did to both of them in both the corners.* they were separate beneath but joined at the top, at the first ring. He made two of them this way for the two corners.
- 30 *And there were eight boards; and their sockets were sixteen sockets of silver, under every board two sockets.* There were eight frames with their bases of silver: sixteen bases, under every frame two bases.
- 31 *And he made bars of shittim wood; five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle,* He made bars of acacia wood, five for the frames of the one side of the tabernacle,
- 32 *And five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the tabernacle for the sides westward.* five bars for the frames of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the frames of the tabernacle at the rear westward.
- 33 *And he made the middle bar to shoot through the boards from the one end to the other.* he made the middle bar to run from end to end halfway up the frames.

- 34 *And he overlaid the boards with gold, and made their rings of gold to be places for the bars, and overlaid the bars with gold.* he overlaid the frames with gold, and made their rings of gold for holders for the bars, and overlaid the bars with gold.
- 35 *And he made a veil of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen: with cherubims made he it of cunning work.* He made the veil of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen; with cherubim skillfully worked into it he made it.
- 36 *And he made thereunto four pillars of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold: their hooks were of gold; and he cast for them four sockets of silver.* for it he made four pillars of acacia and overlaid them with gold. Their hooks were of gold. He cast for them four bases of silver.
- 37 *And he made an hanging for the tabernacle door of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, of needlework;* He also made a screen for the entrance of the tent, of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen, embroidered with needlework,
- 38 *And the five pillars of it with their hooks: and he overlaid their chapiters and their fillets with gold: but their five sockets were of brass.* its five pillars with their hooks. He overlaid their capitals and their fillets with gold. Their five bases were of bronze.

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 28:3; Ex 35:30-35; Ex 31:1-6; Ex 25:8; Ex 39:1-40:38

v2 — Col 4:17; Ex 31:6; Heb 5:4

v3 — Ex 35:29

v5 — 2 Chr 31:6-10; 2 Cor 8:2-3; 2 Chr 24:14

Chapter 37

Bezaleel constructed the ark of the covenant, overlaid it inside and out with pure gold, and made the mercy seat with two golden cherubim with wings spread above it. He also made the

table of showbread with its dishes and utensils of pure gold, the seven-branched lampstand of beaten gold, and the altar of incense overlaid with gold, along with the holy anointing oil and the pure incense.

- 1 *And Bezaleel made the ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half was the length of it, and a cubit and a half the breadth of it, and a cubit and a half the height of it:* Bezaleel made the ark of acacia wood. Two and a half cubits was its length, a cubit and a half its breadth, and a cubit and a half its height.
- 2 *And he overlaid it with pure gold within and without, and made a crown of gold to it round about.* he overlaid it with pure gold inside and outside, and made a molding of gold around it.
- 3 *And he cast for it four rings of gold, to be set by the four corners of it; even two rings upon the one side of it, and two rings upon the other side of it.* he cast for it four rings of gold for its four feet, two rings on its one side and two rings on its other side.
- 4 *And he made staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold.* he made poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with gold
- 5 *And he put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, to bear the ark.* put the poles into the rings on the sides of the ark to carry the ark.
- 6 *And he made the mercy seat of pure gold: two cubits and a half was the length thereof, and one cubit and a half the breadth thereof.* he made a mercy seat of pure gold. Two and a half cubits was its length, and a cubit and a half its breadth.
- 7 *And he made two cherubims of gold, beaten out of one piece made he them, on the two ends of the mercy seat;* he made two cherubim of gold. He made them of hammered work on the two ends of the mercy seat,
- 8 *One cherub on the end on this side, and another cherub on the other end on that side: out of the mercy seat made he the cherubims on the two ends thereof.* one cherub on the one end, and one cherub on the other end. Of one piece with the mercy seat he made the cherubim on its two ends.

- 9 *And the cherubims spread out their wings on high, and covered with their wings over the mercy seat, with their faces one to another; even to the mercy seatward were the faces of the cherubims.* The cherubim spread out their wings above, overshadowing the mercy seat with their wings, with their faces one to another; toward the mercy seat were the faces of the cherubim.
- 10 *And he made the table of shittim wood: two cubits was the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof:* He also made the table of acacia wood. Two cubits was its length, a cubit its breadth, and a cubit and a half its height.
- 11 *And he overlaid it with pure gold, and made thereunto a crown of gold round about.* he overlaid it with pure gold and made a molding of gold around it.
- 12 *Also he made thereunto a border of an handbreadth round about; and made a crown of gold for the border thereof round about.* he made a rim around it a handbreadth wide, and made a molding of gold around the rim.
- 13 *And he cast for it four rings of gold, and put the rings upon the four corners that were in the four feet thereof.* He cast for it four rings of gold and fastened the rings to the four corners at its four legs.
- 14 *Over against the border were the rings, the places for the staves to bear the table.* Close to the frame were the rings, as holders for the poles to carry the table.
- 15 *And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold, to bear the table.* He made the poles of acacia wood to carry the table, and overlaid them with gold.
- 16 *And he made the vessels which were upon the table, his dishes, and his spoons, and his bowls, and his covers to cover withal, of pure gold.* he made the vessels of pure gold that were to be on the table, its plates and dishes for incense, and its bowls and flagons with which to pour drink offerings.

- 17 *And he made the candlestick of pure gold: of beaten work made he the candlestick; his shaft, and his branch, his bowls, his knops, and his flowers, were of the same:* He also made the lampstand of pure gold. He made the lampstand of hammered work. Its base, its stem, its cups, its calyxes, and its flowers were of one piece with it.
- 18 *And six branches going out of the sides thereof; three branches of the candlestick out of the one side thereof, and three branches of the candlestick out of the other side thereof:* there were six branches going out of its sides, three branches of the lampstand out of one side of it and three branches of the lampstand out of the other side of it;
- 19 *Three bowls made after the fashion of almonds in one branch, a knop and a flower; and three bowls made like almonds in another branch, a knop and a flower: so throughout the six branches going out of the candlestick.* three cups made like almond blossoms, each with calyx and flower, on one branch, and three cups made like almond blossoms, each with calyx and flower, on the other branch — so for the six branches going out of the lampstand.
- 20 *And in the candlestick were four bowls made like almonds, his knops, and his flowers:* on the lampstand itself were four cups made like almond blossoms, with their calyxes and flowers,
- 21 *And a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, according to the six branches going out of it.* a calyx of one piece with it under each pair of the six branches going out of it.
- 22 *Their knops and their branches were of the same: all of it was one beaten work of pure gold.* Their calyxes and their branches were of one piece with it, the whole of it a single piece of hammered work of pure gold.
- 23 *And he made his seven lamps, and his snuffers, and his snuffdishes, of pure gold.* he made its seven lamps and its tongs and its trays of pure gold.
- 24 *Of a talent of pure gold made he it, and all the vessels thereof.* He made it and all its utensils of a talent of pure gold.

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| 25 | <i>And he made the incense altar of shittim wood: the length of it was a cubit, and the breadth of it a cubit; it was foursquare; and two cubits was the height of it; the horns thereof were of the same.</i> | He made the altar of incense of acacia wood. Its length was a cubit, and its breadth was a cubit. It was square, and two cubits was its height. Its horns were of one piece with it. |
| 26 | <i>And he overlaid it with pure gold, both the top of it, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns of it: also he made unto it a crown of gold round about.</i> | He overlaid it with pure gold, its top and around its sides and its horns. And he made a molding of gold around it, |
| 27 | <i>And he made two rings of gold for it under the crown thereof, by the two corners of it, upon the two sides thereof, to be places for the staves to bear it withal.</i> | made two rings of gold on it under its molding, on two opposite sides of it, as holders for the poles with which to carry it. |
| 28 | <i>And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold.</i> | he made the poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with gold. |
| 29 | <i>And he made the holy anointing oil, and the pure incense of sweet spices, according to the work of the apothecary.</i> | He made the holy anointing oil also, and the pure fragrant incense, blended as by the perfumer. |

Words in this chapter:

- mercy seat** — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.
- candlestick** — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.
- incense** — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

v25 — Ex 30:1-5

Chapter 38

The bronze altar of burnt offering and the bronze basin were constructed, and the court of the tabernacle was set up with its pillars, hangings, and gate screen. An accounting of the materials used is given: the gold from the offering totaled twenty-nine talents and 730 shekels, the silver came from the atonement money of 603,550 men at a half-shekel each, and the bronze of the offering was seventy talents and 2,400 shekels.

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| 1 <i>And he made the altar of burnt offering of shittim wood: five cubits was the length thereof, and five cubits the breadth thereof; it was foursquare; and three cubits the height thereof.</i> | He made the altar of burnt offering of acacia wood. Five cubits was its length, and five cubits its breadth. It was square, and three cubits was its height. |
| 2 <i>And he made the horns thereof on the four corners of it; the horns thereof were of the same: and he overlaid it with brass.</i> | He made horns for it on its four corners. Its horns were of one piece with it. He overlaid it with bronze. |
| 3 <i>And he made all the vessels of the altar, the pots, and the shovels, and the basons, and the fleshhooks, and the firepans: all the vessels thereof made he of brass.</i> | he made all the utensils of the altar, the pots, the shovels, the basins, the forks, and the fire pans. He made all its utensils of bronze. |
| 4 <i>And he made for the altar a brasen grate of network under the compass thereof beneath unto the midst of it.</i> | he made for the altar a grating, a network of bronze, under its ledge, extending halfway down. |
| 5 <i>And he cast four rings for the four ends of the grate of brass, to be places for the staves.</i> | He cast four rings on the four corners of the bronze grating as holders for the poles. |
| 6 <i>And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with brass.</i> | He made the poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with bronze. |
| 7 <i>And he put the staves into the rings on the sides of the altar, to bear it withal; he made the altar hollow with boards.</i> | he put the poles through the rings on the sides of the altar to carry it with them. He made it hollow, with boards. |

- 8 *And he made the laver of brass, and the foot of it of brass, of the lookingglasses of the women assembling, which assembled at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* He made the basin of bronze and its stand of bronze, from the mirrors of the ministering women who ministered in the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 9 *And he made the court: on the south side southward the hangings of the court were of fine twined linen, an hundred cubits:* he made the court. For the south side the hangings of the court were of fine twined linen, a hundred cubits;
- 10 *Their pillars were twenty, and their brasen sockets twenty; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver.* their twenty pillars and their twenty bases were of bronze, but the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver.
- 11 *And for the north side the hangings were an hundred cubits, their pillars were twenty, and their sockets of brass twenty; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.* for the north side there were hangings a hundred cubits; their twenty pillars and their twenty bases were of bronze, but the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver.
- 12 *And for the west side were hangings of fifty cubits, their pillars ten, and their sockets ten; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.* for the west side were hangings of fifty cubits, their ten pillars. Their ten bases; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver.
- 13 *And for the east side eastward fifty cubits.* for the front to the east, fifty cubits.
- 14 *The hangings of the one side of the gate were fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three.* The hangings for the one side of the gate were fifteen cubits, with their three pillars and three bases.
- 15 *And for the other side of the court gate, on this hand and that hand, were hangings of fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three.* so for the other side; on both sides of the gate of the court were hangings of fifteen cubits, with their three pillars and their three bases.
- 16 *All the hangings of the court round about were of fine twined linen.* All the hangings around the court were of fine twined linen.

- 17 *And the sockets for the pillars were of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver; and the overlaying of their chapters of silver; and all the pillars of the court were filleted with silver.* the bases for the pillars were of bronze, but the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver. The overlaying of their capitals was also of silver. All the pillars of the court were filleted with silver.
- 18 *And the hanging for the gate of the court was needlework, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen: and twenty cubits was the length, and the height in the breadth was five cubits, answerable to the hangings of the court.* the screen for the gate of the court was embroidered with needlework in blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen. It was twenty cubits long and five cubits high in its breadth, corresponding to the hangings of the court.
- 19 *And their pillars were four, and their sockets of brass four; their hooks of silver, and the overlaying of their chapters and their fillets of silver.* their pillars were four in number. Their four bases were of bronze, their hooks of silver, and the overlaying of their capitals and their fillets of silver.
- 20 *And all the pins of the tabernacle, and of the court round about, were of brass.* all the pegs for the tabernacle and for the court all around were of bronze.
- 21 *This is the sum of the tabernacle, even of the tabernacle of testimony, as it was counted, according to the commandment of Moses, for the service of the Levites, by the hand of Ithamar, son to Aaron the priest.* These are the records of the tabernacle, the tabernacle of the testimony, as they were recorded at the commandment of Moses, the responsibility of the Levites under the direction of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.
- 22 *And Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made all that the LORD commanded Moses.* Bezaleel the son of Uri, son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made all that the LORD commanded Moses;
- 23 *And with him was Aholiab, son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an engraver, and a cunning workman, and an embroiderer in blue, and in purple, and in scarlet, and fine linen.* with Him was Aholiab the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an engraver and designer and embroiderer in blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen.

- 24 *All the gold that was occupied for the work in all the work of the holy place, even the gold of the offering, was twenty and nine talents, and seven hundred and thirty shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary.* All the gold that was used for the work, in all the construction of the sanctuary, the gold from the offering, was twenty-nine talents and 730 shekels, by the shekel of the sanctuary.
- 25 *And the silver of them that were numbered of the congregation was an hundred talents, and a thousand seven hundred and threescore and fifteen shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary:* The silver from those of the congregation who were numbered was 100 talents and 1,775 shekels, by the shekel of the sanctuary:
- 26 *A bekah for every man, that is, half a shekel, after the shekel of the sanctuary, for every one that went to be numbered, from twenty years old and upward, for six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty men.* a beka a head (that is, half a shekel, by the shekel of the sanctuary), for everyone who was numbered in the census, from twenty years old and upward, for 603,550 men.
- 27 *And of the hundred talents of silver were cast the sockets of the sanctuary, and the sockets of the vail; an hundred sockets of the hundred talents, a talent for a socket.* The hundred talents of silver were for casting the bases of the sanctuary and the bases of the veil; a hundred bases for the hundred talents, a talent a base.
- 28 *And of the thousand seven hundred seventy and five shekels he made hooks for the pillars, and overlaid their chapiters, and filleted them.* of the 1,775 shekels He made hooks for the pillars and overlaid their capitals and made fillets for them.
- 29 *And the brass of the offering was seventy talents, and two thousand and four hundred shekels.* The bronze that was offered was seventy talents and 2,400 shekels;

- 30 *And therewith he made the sockets to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the brasen altar, and the brasen grate for it, and all the vessels of the altar,* with it He made the bases for the entrance of the tent of meeting, the bronze altar and the bronze grating for it and all the utensils of the altar,
- 31 *And the sockets of the court round about, and the sockets of the court gate, and all the pins of the tabernacle, and all the pins of the court round about.* the bases around the court, and the bases of the gate of the court, all the pegs of the tabernacle. All the pegs around the court.

Words in this chapter:

- laver** (*LAY-ver*) — The large bronze basin in the tabernacle courtyard — priests washed their hands and feet here before approaching God's altar.
- Dan** (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'
- Judah** (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ex 27:1-8
- v8** — 1 Sam 2:22; Luke 2:37; Ex 40:7
- v21** — Acts 7:44
- v23** — Ex 35:34
- v24** — Lev 27:25; Num 18:16; Num 3:47
- v26** — Num 1:46; Ex 30:13

Chapter 39

The priestly garments were made exactly as the LORD commanded: the ephod of gold, blue, purple, and scarlet; the breastplate set with twelve stones; the robe of the ephod with pomegranates and golden bells; the linen coats, the mitre with its golden plate reading "HOLINESS TO THE LORD," and the garments for Aaron's sons. All the work of the tabernacle was completed; the people brought everything to Moses, and he saw that they had done it as the LORD commanded, and Moses blessed them.

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| 1 | <i>And of the blue, and purple, and scarlet, they made cloths of service, to do service in the holy place, and made the holy garments for Aaron; as the LORD commanded Moses.</i> | From the blue and purple and scarlet yarns they made finely woven garments, for ministering in the Holy Place. They made the holy garments for Aaron, as the LORD had commanded Moses. |
| 2 | <i>And he made the ephod of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.</i> | He made the ephod of gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen. |
| 3 | <i>And they did beat the gold into thin plates, and cut it into wires, to work it in the blue, and in the purple, and in the scarlet, and in the fine linen, with cunning work.</i> | they hammered out gold leaf. He cut it into threads to work into the blue and purple and the scarlet yarns, and into the fine twined linen, in skilled design. |
| 4 | <i>They made shoulderpieces for it, to couple it together: by the two edges was it coupled together.</i> | They made for the ephod attaching shoulder pieces, joined to it at its two edges. |
| 5 | <i>And the curious girdle of his ephod, that was upon it, was of the same, according to the work thereof; of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen; as the LORD commanded Moses.</i> | the skillfully woven band on it was of one piece with it and made like it, of gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen, as the LORD had commanded Moses. |
| 6 | <i>And they wrought onyx stones inclosed in ouches of gold, graven, as signets are graven, with the names of the children of Israel.</i> | They made the onyx stones, enclosed in settings of gold filigree, and engraved like the engravings of a signet, according to the names of the sons of Israel. |
| 7 | <i>And he put them on the shoulders of the ephod, that they should be stones for a memorial to the children of Israel; as the LORD commanded Moses.</i> | he set them on the shoulder pieces of the ephod to be stones of remembrance for the sons of Israel, as the LORD had commanded Moses. |

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| 8 | <i>And he made the breastplate of cunning work, like the work of the ephod; of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.</i> | He made the breastpiece, in skilled work, in the style of the ephod, of gold, blue and purple and scarlet yarns, and fine twined linen. |
| 9 | <i>It was foursquare; they made the breastplate double: a span was the length thereof, and a span the breadth thereof, being doubled.</i> | It was square. They made the breastpiece doubled, a span its length and a span its breadth when doubled. |
| 10 | <i>And they set in it four rows of stones: the first row was a sardius, a topaz, and a carbuncle: this was the first row.</i> | they set in it four rows of stones. A row of sardius, topaz, and carbuncle was the first row; |
| 11 | <i>And the second row, an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond.</i> | the second row, an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond; |
| 12 | <i>And the third row, a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst.</i> | the third row, a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst; |
| 13 | <i>And the fourth row, a beryl, an onyx, and a jasper: they were inclosed in ouches of gold in their inclosings.</i> | the fourth row, a beryl, an onyx, and a jasper. They were enclosed in settings of gold filigree. |
| 14 | <i>And the stones were according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names, like the engravings of a signet, every one with his name, according to the twelve tribes.</i> | There were twelve stones with their names according to the names of the sons of Israel. They were like signets, each engraved with its name, for the twelve tribes. |
| 15 | <i>And they made upon the breastplate chains at the ends, of wreathen work of pure gold.</i> | they made on the breastpiece twisted chains like cords, of pure gold. |
| 16 | <i>And they made two ouches of gold, and two gold rings; and put the two rings in the two ends of the breastplate.</i> | they made two settings of gold filigree and two gold rings, and put the two rings on the two edges of the breastpiece. |

- 17 *And they put the two wreathen chains of gold in the two rings on the ends of the breastplate.* they put the two cords of gold in the two rings at the edges of the breastpiece.
- 18 *And the two ends of the two wreathen chains they fastened in the two ouches, and put them on the shoulderpieces of the ephod, before it.* They attached the two ends of the two cords to the two settings of filigree. Thus they attached it in front to the shoulder pieces of the ephod.
- 19 *And they made two rings of gold, and put them on the two ends of the breastplate, upon the border of it, which was on the side of the ephod inward.* Then they made two rings of gold, and put them at the two ends of the breastpiece, on its inside edge next to the ephod.
- 20 *And they made two other golden rings, and put them on the two sides of the ephod underneath, toward the forepart of it, over against the other coupling thereof, above the curious girdle of the ephod.* they made two rings of gold, and attached them in front to the lower part of the two shoulder pieces of the ephod, at its seam above the skillfully woven band of the ephod.
- 21 *And they did bind the breastplate by his rings unto the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it might be above the curious girdle of the ephod, and that the breastplate might not be loosed from the ephod; as the LORD commanded Moses.* they bound the breastpiece by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, so that it should lie on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, and that the breastpiece should not come loose from the ephod, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 22 *And he made the robe of the ephod of woven work, all of blue.* He also made the robe of the ephod woven all of blue,
- 23 *And there was an hole in the midst of the robe, as the hole of an habergeon, with a band round about the hole, that it should not rend.* the opening of the robe in it was like the opening in a garment, with a binding around the opening, so that it might not tear.
- 24 *And they made upon the hems of the robe pomegranates of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and twined linen.* On the hem of the robe they made pomegranates of blue and purple and scarlet yarns and fine twined linen.

- 25 *And they made bells of pure gold, and put the bells between the pomegranates upon the hem of the robe, round about between the pomegranates;* They also made bells of pure gold, and put the bells between the pomegranates all around the hem of the robe, between the pomegranates —
- 26 *A bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate, round about the hem of the robe to minister in; as the LORD commanded Moses.* a bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate around the hem of the robe for ministering, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 27 *And they made coats of fine linen of woven work for Aaron, and for his sons,* They also made the coats, woven of fine linen, for Aaron and his sons,
- 28 *And a mitre of fine linen, and goodly bonnets of fine linen, and linen breeches of fine twined linen,* the turban of fine linen, and the caps of fine linen, and the linen undergarments of fine twined linen,
- 29 *And a girdle of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet, of needlework; as the LORD commanded Moses.* the sash of fine twined linen and of blue and purple and scarlet yarns, embroidered with needlework, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 30 *And they made the plate of the holy crown of pure gold, and wrote upon it a writing, like to the engravings of a signet, HOLINESS TO THE LORD.* They made the plate of the holy crown of pure gold, and wrote on it an inscription, like the engraving of a signet, Holy to the LORD.
- 31 *And they tied unto it a lace of blue, to fasten it on high upon the mitre; as the LORD commanded Moses.* they tied to it a cord of blue to fasten it on the turban above, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 32 *Thus was all the work of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation finished: and the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did they.* Thus all the work of the tabernacle of the tent of meeting was finished, and the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD had commanded Moses; so they did.

- 33 *And they brought the tabernacle unto Moses, the tent, and all his furniture, his taches, his boards, his bars, and his pillars, and his sockets,* Then they brought the tabernacle to Moses, the tent and all its utensils, its hooks, its frames, its bars, its pillars, and its bases;
- 34 *And the covering of rams' skins dyed red, and the covering of badgers' skins, and the veil of the covering,* the covering of tanned rams' skins and goatskins, and the veil of the screen;
- 35 *The ark of the testimony, and the staves thereof, and the mercy seat,* the ark of the testimony with its poles and the mercy seat;
- 36 *The table, and all the vessels thereof, and the shewbread,* the table with all its utensils, and the bread of the Presence;
- 37 *The pure candlestick, with the lamps thereof, even with the lamps to be set in order, and all the vessels thereof, and the oil for light,* the lampstand of pure gold and its lamps with the lamps set. All its utensils, and the oil for the light;
- 38 *And the golden altar, and the anointing oil, and the sweet incense, and the hanging for the tabernacle door,* the golden altar, the anointing oil and the fragrant incense, and the screen for the entrance of the tent;
- 39 *The brasen altar, and his grate of brass, his staves, and all his vessels, the laver and his foot,* the bronze altar, and its grating of bronze, its poles. All its utensils; the basin and its stand;
- 40 *The hangings of the court, his pillars, and his sockets, and the hanging for the court gate, his cords, and his pins, and all the vessels of the service of the tabernacle, for the tent of the congregation,* the hangings of the court, its pillars, and its bases, and the screen for the gate of the court, its cords, and its pegs. All the utensils for the service of the tabernacle, for the tent of meeting;
- 41 *The cloths of service to do service in the holy place, and the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and his sons' garments, to minister in the priest's office.* the finely worked garments for ministering in the Holy Place, the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons for their service as priests.

- 42

According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel made all the work.

According to all that the LORD had commanded Moses, so the children of Israel had done all the work.
- 43

And Moses did look upon all the work, and, behold, they had done it as the LORD had commanded, even so had they done it: and Moses blessed them.

Moses saw all the work. They had done it; as the LORD had commanded, so had they done it. Then Moses blessed them.

Words in this chapter:

- ark of the testimony** — Another name for the ark of the covenant — 'testimony' refers to the tablets of the law stored inside it.
- breastplate** — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.
- ephod** (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.
- mitre** (*MY-ter*) — The turban-like headdress worn by the high priest — a fine linen cap with a gold plate on the front engraved 'HOLINESS TO THE LORD.'
- shewbread** (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 31:10; Ex 35:23; Ex 35:19
- v2 — Ex 28:6-12
- v7 — Josh 4:7
- v14 — Rev 21:12
- v43 — Lev 9:22-23; Num 6:23-27

Chapter 40

The LORD commanded Moses to set up the tabernacle on the first day of the first month; Moses erected the structure, placed the ark inside the most holy place, hung the veil, arranged the table, lampstand, and golden altar, and anointed everything with oil. He consecrated Aaron and his sons and set up the court around the tabernacle. When the work was finished, the cloud covered the tent of meeting and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle so that Moses could not enter; the cloud of the LORD was on the tabernacle by day and fire by night throughout all Israel's journeys.

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And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

The LORD said to Moses,

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| 2 | <i>On the first day of the first month shalt thou set up the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation.</i> | <i>'On the first day of the first month You shall erect the tabernacle of the tent of meeting.</i> |
| 3 | <i>And thou shalt put therein the ark of the testimony, and cover the ark with the veil.</i> | <i>you shall put in it the ark of the testimony, and You shall screen the ark with the veil.</i> |
| 4 | <i>And thou shalt bring in the table, and set in order the things that are to be set in order upon it; and thou shalt bring in the candlestick, and light the lamps thereof.</i> | <i>you shall bring in the table and arrange it, and You shall bring in the lampstand and set up its lamps.</i> |
| 5 | <i>And thou shalt set the altar of gold for the incense before the ark of the testimony, and put the hanging of the door to the tabernacle.</i> | <i>you shall put the golden altar for incense before the ark of the testimony, and set up the screen for the door of the tabernacle.</i> |
| 6 | <i>And thou shalt set the altar of the burnt offering before the door of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation.</i> | <i>You shall set the altar of burnt offering before the door of the tabernacle of the tent of meeting,</i> |
| 7 | <i>And thou shalt set the laver between the tent of the congregation and the altar, and shalt put water therein.</i> | <i>place the basin between the tent of meeting and the altar, and put water in it.</i> |
| 8 | <i>And thou shalt set up the court round about, and hang up the hanging at the court gate.</i> | <i>you shall set up the court all around, and hang up the screen for the gate of the court.</i> |
| 9 | <i>And thou shalt take the anointing oil, and anoint the tabernacle, and all that is therein, and shalt hallow it, and all the vessels thereof: and it shall be holy.</i> | <i>Then You shall take the anointing oil and anoint the tabernacle and all that is in it, and consecrate it and all its furniture, so that it may become holy.</i> |
| 10 | <i>And thou shalt anoint the altar of the burnt offering, and all his vessels, and sanctify the altar: and it shall be an altar most holy.</i> | <i>You shall also anoint the altar of burnt offering and all its utensils, and consecrate the altar, so that the altar may become most holy.</i> |

- 11 *And thou shalt anoint the laver and his foot, and sanctify it.* You shall also anoint the basin and its stand, and consecrate it.
- 12 *And thou shalt bring Aaron and his sons unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and wash them with water.* Then you shall bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance of the tent of meeting and shall wash them with water
- 13 *And thou shalt put upon Aaron the holy garments, and anoint him, and sanctify him; that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.* put on Aaron the holy garments. And you shall anoint him and consecrate him, that he may serve me as priest.
- 14 *And thou shalt bring his sons, and clothe them with coats:* You shall bring his sons also and put coats on them,
- 15 *And thou shalt anoint them, as thou didst anoint their father, that they may minister unto me in the priest's office: for their anointing shall surely be an everlasting priesthood throughout their generations.* anoint them, as you anointed their father, that they may serve me as priests. And their anointing shall admit them to a perpetual priesthood throughout their generations.'
- 16 *Thus did Moses: according to all that the LORD commanded him, so did he.* This Moses did; according to all that the LORD commanded Him, so He did.
- 17 *And it came to pass in the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, that the tabernacle was reared up.* In the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, the tabernacle was erected.
- 18 *And Moses reared up the tabernacle, and fastened his sockets, and set up the boards thereof, and put in the bars thereof, and reared up his pillars.* Moses erected the tabernacle. He laid its bases, and set up its frames, and put in its bars, and raised up its pillars.
- 19 *And he spread abroad the tent over the tabernacle, and put the covering of the tent above upon it; as the LORD commanded Moses.* he spread the tent over the tabernacle and put the covering of the tent over it, as the LORD had commanded Moses.

- 20 *And he took and put the testimony into the ark, and set the staves on the ark, and put the mercy seat above upon the ark:* He took the testimony and put it into the ark, and put the poles on the ark and set the mercy seat above on the ark.
- 21 *And he brought the ark into the tabernacle, and set up the vail of the covering, and covered the ark of the testimony; as the LORD commanded Moses.* he brought the ark into the tabernacle and set up the veil of the screen, and screened the ark of the testimony, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 22 *And he put the table in the tent of the congregation, upon the side of the tabernacle northward, without the vail.* He put the table in the tent of meeting, on the north side of the tabernacle, outside the veil,
- 23 *And he set the bread in order upon it before the LORD; as the LORD had commanded Moses.* arranged the bread on it before the LORD, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 24 *And he put the candlestick in the tent of the congregation, over against the table, on the side of the tabernacle southward.* He put the lampstand in the tent of meeting, opposite the table on the south side of the tabernacle,
- 25 *And he lighted the lamps before the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.* set up the lamps before the LORD, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 26 *And he put the golden altar in the tent of the congregation before the vail:* He put the golden altar in the tent of meeting before the veil,
- 27 *And he burnt sweet incense thereon; as the LORD commanded Moses.* burned fragrant incense on it, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 28 *And he set up the hanging at the door of the tabernacle.* He also set up the screen for the entrance of the tabernacle.

- 29 *And he put the altar of burnt offering by the door of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation, and offered upon it the burnt offering and the meat offering; as the LORD commanded Moses.* he set the altar of burnt offering at the entrance of the tabernacle of the tent of meeting, and offered on it the burnt offering and the grain offering, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 30 *And he set the laver between the tent of the congregation and the altar, and put water there, to wash withal.* He set the basin between the tent of meeting and the altar, and put water in it for washing,
- 31 *And Moses and Aaron and his sons washed their hands and their feet thereat:* with which Moses and Aaron and his sons washed their hands and their feet.
- 32 *When they went into the tent of the congregation, and when they came near unto the altar, they washed; as the LORD commanded Moses.* When they went into the tent of meeting, and when they approached the altar, they washed, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 33 *And he reared up the court round about the tabernacle and the altar, and set up the hanging of the court gate. So Moses finished the work.* he erected the court around the tabernacle and the altar, and set up the screen of the gate of the court. So Moses finished the work.
- 34 *Then a cloud covered the tent of the congregation, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.* Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.
- 35 *And Moses was not able to enter into the tent of the congregation, because the cloud abode thereon, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.* Moses was not able to enter the tent of meeting because the cloud settled on it, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.
- 36 *And when the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel went onward in all their journeys:* Throughout all their journeys, whenever the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel would set out.

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| <p>37 <i>But if the cloud were not taken up, then they journeyed not till the day that it was taken up.</i></p> <p>38 <i>For the cloud of the LORD was upon the tabernacle by day, and fire was on it by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel, throughout all their journeys.</i></p> | <p>But if the cloud was not taken up, then they did not set out till the day that it was taken up.</p> <p>For the cloud of the LORD was on the tabernacle by day, and fire was in it by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel throughout all their journeys.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ex 26:30
- v3 — Num 4:5; Ex 35:12
- v9 — Lev 8:10
- v12 — Lev 8:1-13
- v13 — Ex 28:41
- v15 — Num 25:13
- v21 — Ex 26:33; Ex 40:3
- v22 — Ex 26:35
- v25 — Ex 40:4; Ex 25:37
- v34 — Rev 15:8; Num 9:15-23; 2 Chr 7:2; Ex 14:24; Ex 29:43
- v35 — 1 Kgs 8:11; Lev 16:2; 2 Chr 7:2
- v38 — Ps 78:14; Num 9:15; Ex 13:21; Isa 4:5-6; Ps 105:39

Leviticus

Author: Moses — *Leviticus is the direct continuation of Exodus, recording what the LORD spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting (Lev 1:1).*

Date written: c. 1445 BC, while Israel camped at the foot of Sinai.

Written to: The priests of Israel (Levites) and through them the whole nation.

Setting: Israel has just completed the tabernacle (end of Exodus). The cloud of glory has filled it. Now God speaks from it, laying out exactly how sinful people may approach a holy God.

Where this sits historically: c. 1446–1445 BC at Mount Sinai during Egypt's New Kingdom under the 18th dynasty; Israel encamped at the foot of the mountain for roughly a year.

Contemporaries: Egypt's Thutmose III / Amenhotep II reigns; the Hittite empire ascendant in Anatolia. Exodus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy are written by Moses in this same era.

Big themes:

- Holiness — "Be ye holy; for I am holy" (Lev 11:44) is the book's heartbeat; God's holiness makes ritual purity necessary

- Sacrifice — five types of offering define how sin is covered and fellowship with God is maintained

- Atonement — the Day of Atonement (ch. 16) is the annual reset for the whole nation's sin

- The priesthood — Aaron and his sons are set apart to mediate between God and the people

- Clean and unclean — dietary laws and purity codes mark Israel as distinct from all surrounding nations

Key passages: Lev 11:44; 16:15–16; 17:11; 19:18; 23:1–3

How it fits: Leviticus sits at the center of the Pentateuch for a reason — the entire law turns on how to maintain relationship with a holy God. Hebrews 9–10 reads Leviticus as a detailed preview of Christ's once-for-all sacrifice. Without Leviticus, Hebrews is incomprehensible.

Chapter 1

The LORD gives instructions for the burnt offering. An unblemished male from the herd, flock, or a bird is to be killed, its blood thrown against the altar, and the whole animal burned as a sweet savour to the LORD.

- 1 And the LORD called unto Moses, and The LORD called Moses and spoke to
spake unto him out of the tabernacle him from the tent of meeting, saying,
of the congregation, saying,

- 2 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, If any man of you bring an offering unto the LORD, ye shall bring your offering of the cattle, even of the herd, and of the flock.* 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, When any one of You brings an offering to the LORD, You shall bring Your offering of livestock, from the herd or from the flock.
- 3 *If his offering be a burnt sacrifice of the herd, let him offer a male without blemish: he shall offer it of his own voluntary will at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD.* If His offering is a burnt offering from the herd, He shall offer a male without blemish. He shall bring it to the entrance of the tent of meeting, that He may be accepted before the LORD.
- 4 *And he shall put his hand upon the head of the burnt offering; and it shall be accepted for him to make atonement for him.* He shall lay His hand on the head of the burnt offering. It shall be accepted for Him to make atonement for Him.
- 5 *And he shall kill the bullock before the LORD: and the priests, Aaron's sons, shall bring the blood, and sprinkle the blood round about upon the altar that is by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* Then He shall kill the bull before the LORD, and Aaron's sons the priests shall bring the blood and throw the blood against the sides of the altar that is at the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 6 *And he shall flay the burnt offering, and cut it into his pieces.* Then He shall flay the burnt offering and cut it into pieces,
- 7 *And the sons of Aaron the priest shall put fire upon the altar, and lay the wood in order upon the fire:* the sons of Aaron the priest shall put fire on the altar and arrange wood on the fire.
- 8 *And the priests, Aaron's sons, shall lay the parts, the head, and the fat, in order upon the wood that is on the fire which is upon the altar:* Aaron's sons the priests shall arrange the pieces, the head, and the fat, on the wood that is on the fire on the altar;
- 9 *But his inwards and his legs shall he wash in water: and the priest shall burn all on the altar, to be a burnt sacrifice, an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* but its entrails and its legs He shall wash with water. And the priest shall burn all of it on the altar, as a burnt offering, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

- 10 *And if his offering be of the flocks, namely, of the sheep, or of the goats, for a burnt sacrifice; he shall bring it a male without blemish.* If His gift for a burnt offering is from the flock, from the sheep or goats, He shall bring a male without blemish,
- 11 *And he shall kill it on the side of the altar northward before the LORD: and the priests, Aaron's sons, shall sprinkle his blood round about upon the altar.* he shall kill it on the north side of the altar before the LORD, and Aaron's sons the priests shall throw its blood against the sides of the altar.
- 12 *And he shall cut it into his pieces, with his head and his fat: and the priest shall lay them in order on the wood that is on the fire which is upon the altar:* he shall cut it into pieces, with its head and its fat, and the priest shall arrange them on the wood that is on the fire on the altar,
- 13 *But he shall wash the inwards and the legs with water: and the priest shall bring it all, and burn it upon the altar: it is a burnt sacrifice, an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* but the entrails and the legs He shall wash with water. And the priest shall offer all of it and burn it on the altar; it is a burnt offering, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 14 *And if the burnt sacrifice for his offering to the LORD be of fowls, then he shall bring his offering of turtledoves, or of young pigeons.* If His offering to the LORD is a burnt offering of birds, then He shall bring His offering of turtledoves or pigeons.
- 15 *And the priest shall bring it unto the altar, and wring off his head, and burn it on the altar; and the blood thereof shall be wrung out at the side of the altar:* the priest shall bring it to the altar and wring off its head and burn it on the altar. Its blood shall be drained out on the side of the altar.
- 16 *And he shall pluck away his crop with his feathers, and cast it beside the altar on the east part, by the place of the ashes:* He shall remove its crop with its contents and cast it beside the altar on the east side, in the place for ashes.

- 17 *And he shall cleave it with the wings thereof, but shall not divide it asunder: and the priest shall burn it upon the altar, upon the wood that is upon the fire: it is a burnt sacrifice, an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* He shall tear it open by its wings, but shall not sever it completely. And the priest shall burn it on the altar, on the wood that is on the fire. It is a burnt offering, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 19:3

v3 — Deut 15:21; Heb 9:14; Lev 22:19-24; Ex 12:5; Eph 5:27

v4 — Ex 29:10; 2 Chr 29:23-24; Lev 4:26; Ex 29:15; Lev 4:20

v5 — Lev 1:11; Lev 3:8; Lev 3:2; 1 Pet 1:2; 2 Chr 35:11

v9 — Gen 8:21; Lev 1:13

v11 — Lev 1:5

v14 — Luke 2:24; Lev 5:7

v17 — Gen 15:10

Chapter 2

The LORD gives instructions for the grain offering. Fine flour mixed with oil and frankincense is brought to the priest, who burns a portion on the altar; the rest belongs to Aaron and his sons.

- 1 *And when any will offer a meat offering unto the LORD, his offering shall be of fine flour; and he shall pour oil upon it, and put frankincense thereon:* When anyone brings a grain offering as an offering to the LORD, His offering shall be of fine flour. He shall pour oil on it and put frankincense on it

- 2 *And he shall bring it to Aaron's sons the priests: and he shall take thereof his handful of the flour thereof, and of the oil thereof, with all the frankincense thereof; and the priest shall burn the memorial of it upon the altar, to be an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD:* bring it to Aaron's sons the priests. And he shall take from it a handful of the fine flour and oil, with all of its frankincense, and the priest shall burn this as its memorial portion on the altar, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 3 *And the remnant of the meat offering shall be Aaron's and his sons': it is a thing most holy of the offerings of the LORD made by fire.* But the rest of the grain offering shall be for Aaron and his sons; it is a most holy part of the LORD's offerings made by fire.
- 4 *And if thou bring an oblation of a meat offering baken in the oven, it shall be unleavened cakes of fine flour mingled with oil, or unleavened wafers anointed with oil.* When You bring a grain offering baked in the oven as an offering, it shall be unleavened loaves of fine flour mixed with oil or unleavened wafers smeared with oil.
- 5 *And if thy oblation be a meat offering baken in a pan, it shall be of fine flour unleavened, mingled with oil.* if Your offering is a grain offering baked on a griddle, it shall be of fine flour unleavened, mixed with oil.
- 6 *Thou shalt part it in pieces, and pour oil thereon: it is a meat offering.* You shall break it in pieces and pour oil on it; it is a grain offering.
- 7 *And if thy oblation be a meat offering baken in the fryingpan, it shall be made of fine flour with oil.* if Your offering is a grain offering cooked in a pan, it shall be made of fine flour with oil.
- 8 *And thou shalt bring the meat offering that is made of these things unto the LORD: and when it is presented unto the priest, he shall bring it unto the altar.* you shall bring the grain offering that is made of these things to the LORD, and when it is presented to the priest, he shall bring it to the altar.
- 9 *And the priest shall take from the meat offering a memorial thereof, and shall burn it upon the altar: it is an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* the priest shall take from the grain offering its memorial portion and burn this on the altar, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

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| <p>10 <i>And that which is left of the meat offering shall be Aaron's and his sons': it is a thing most holy of the offerings of the LORD made by fire.</i></p> <p>11 <i>No meat offering, which ye shall bring unto the LORD, shall be made with leaven: for ye shall burn no leaven, nor any honey, in any offering of the LORD made by fire.</i></p> <p>12 <i>As for the oblation of the firstfruits, ye shall offer them unto the LORD: but they shall not be burnt on the altar for a sweet savour.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And every oblation of thy meat offering shalt thou season with salt; neither shalt thou suffer the salt of the covenant of thy God to be lacking from thy meat offering: with all thine offerings thou shalt offer salt.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And if thou offer a meat offering of thy firstfruits unto the LORD, thou shalt offer for the meat offering of thy firstfruits green ears of corn dried by the fire, even corn beaten out of full ears.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And thou shalt put oil upon it, and lay frankincense thereon: it is a meat offering.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the priest shall burn the memorial of it, part of the beaten corn thereof, and part of the oil thereof, with all the frankincense thereof: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.</i></p> | <p>But the rest of the grain offering shall be for Aaron and his sons; it is a most holy part of the LORD's offerings made by fire.</p> <p>No grain offering that You bring to the LORD shall be made with leaven, for You shall burn no leaven nor any honey as a offering made by fire to the LORD.</p> <p>As an offering of firstfruits You may bring them to the LORD. But they shall not be offered on the altar for a sweet savour.</p> <p>You shall season all Your grain offerings with salt. You shall not let the salt of the covenant with Your God be missing from Your grain offering; with all Your offerings You shall offer salt.</p> <p>If You offer a grain offering of firstfruits to the LORD, You shall offer for the grain offering of Your firstfruits fresh ears, roasted with fire, crushed new grain.</p> <p>you shall put oil on it and lay frankincense on it; it is a grain offering.</p> <p>the priest shall burn as its memorial portion some of the crushed grain and some of the oil with all of its frankincense; it is a offering made by fire to the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

v1 — Lev 6:14-18

v2 — Lev 5:12; Lev 6:15; Acts 10:4

v3 — Lev 10:12-13; Lev 6:16-17; Num 18:9; Lev 21:22

v4 — Ex 29:2; Ps 22:14; 1 Cor 5:7-8

v9 — Lev 2:2

v11 — Luke 12:1; Gal 5:9

v13 — Ezek 43:24; Matt 5:13; Col 4:6; Mark 9:49-50; Num 18:19

Chapter 3

The LORD gives instructions for the peace offering. The worshipper lays his hand on the animal's head and kills it at the entrance of the tent of meeting; the fat and kidneys are burned on the altar, and Israel is forbidden to eat fat or blood.

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| <p>¹ <i>And if his oblation be a sacrifice of peace offering, if he offer it of the herd; whether it be a male or female, he shall offer it without blemish before the LORD.</i></p> | <p>If His offering is a sacrifice of peace offering, if He offers an animal from the herd, male or female, He shall offer it without blemish before the LORD.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And he shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron's sons the priests shall sprinkle the blood upon the altar round about.</i></p> | <p>he shall lay his hand on the head of his offering and kill it at the entrance of the tent of meeting, and Aaron's sons the priests shall throw the blood against the sides of the altar.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And he shall offer of the sacrifice of the peace offering an offering made by fire unto the LORD; the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,</i></p> | <p>from the sacrifice of the peace offering, as a offering made by fire to the LORD, He shall offer the fat covering the entrails and all the fat that is on the entrails,</p> |

- 4 *And the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.* the two kidneys with the fat that is on them at the loins, and the long lobe of the liver that He shall remove with the kidneys.
- 5 *And Aaron's sons shall burn it on the altar upon the burnt sacrifice, which is upon the wood that is on the fire: it is an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* Then Aaron's sons shall burn it on the altar on top of the burnt offering, which is on the wood on the fire; it is a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 6 *And if his offering for a sacrifice of peace offering unto the LORD be of the flock; male or female, he shall offer it without blemish.* If His offering for a sacrifice of peace offering to the LORD is an animal from the flock, male or female, He shall offer it without blemish.
- 7 *If he offer a lamb for his offering, then shall he offer it before the LORD.* If He offers a lamb for His offering, then He shall offer it before the LORD,
- 8 *And he shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it before the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron's sons shall sprinkle the blood thereof round about upon the altar.* lay his hand on the head of his offering, and kill it in front of the tent of meeting. Aaron's sons shall throw its blood against the sides of the altar.
- 9 *And he shall offer of the sacrifice of the peace offering an offering made by fire unto the LORD; the fat thereof, and the whole rump, it shall he take off hard by the backbone; and the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,* Then from the sacrifice of the peace offering He shall offer as a offering made by fire to the LORD its fat; He shall remove the whole fat tail, cut off close to the backbone, and the fat that covers the entrails and all the fat that is on the entrails
- 10 *And the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.* the two kidneys with the fat that is on them at the loins and the long lobe of the liver that He shall remove with the kidneys.
- 11 *And the priest shall burn it upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire unto the LORD.* the priest shall burn it on the altar as a offering made by fire to the LORD.

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| 12 | <i>And if his offering be a goat, then he shall offer it before the LORD.</i> | If His offering is a goat, then He shall offer it before the LORD |
| 13 | <i>And he shall lay his hand upon the head of it, and kill it before the tabernacle of the congregation: and the sons of Aaron shall sprinkle the blood thereof upon the altar round about.</i> | lay his hand on its head and kill it in front of the tent of meeting, and the sons of Aaron shall throw its blood against the sides of the altar. |
| 14 | <i>And he shall offer thereof his offering, even an offering made by fire unto the LORD; the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,</i> | Then He shall offer from it, as His offering for a offering made by fire to the LORD, the fat covering the entrails and all the fat that is on the entrails |
| 15 | <i>And the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.</i> | the two kidneys with the fat that is on them at the loins and the long lobe of the liver that He shall remove with the kidneys. |
| 16 | <i>And the priest shall burn them upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire for a sweet savour: all the fat is the LORD's.</i> | the priest shall burn them on the altar as a offering made by fire with a sweet savour. All fat is the LORD's. |
| 17 | <i>It shall be a perpetual statute for your generations throughout all your dwellings, that ye eat neither fat nor blood.</i> | It shall be a statute forever throughout Your generations, in all Your dwelling places, that You eat neither fat nor blood.' |

Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Cross-References:

v5 — Lev 6:12

v11 — Lev 21:17; Lev 21:6

v16 — Lev 7:23-25

v17 — Gen 9:4; Matt 26:28; Deut 15:23; Lev 7:23; Deut 12:23

Chapter 4

The LORD gives instructions for the sin offering to cover unintentional sins. Different sacrifices are required depending on who sinned -- the anointed priest brings a bull, the whole congregation a bull, a ruler a male goat, and a common person a female goat or lamb.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 2 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, If a soul shall sin through ignorance against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which ought not to be done, and shall do against any of them:*

'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, If anyone sins unintentionally in any of the LORD's commandments about things not to be done, and does any one of them,
- 3 *If the priest that is anointed do sin according to the sin of the people; then let him bring for his sin, which he hath sinned, a young bullock without blemish unto the LORD for a sin offering.*

if it is the anointed priest who sins, thus bringing guilt on the people, then he shall offer for the sin that he has committed a bull from the herd without blemish to the LORD for a sin offering.
- 4 *And he shall bring the bullock unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD; and shall lay his hand upon the bullock's head, and kill the bullock before the LORD.*

He shall bring the bull to the entrance of the tent of meeting before the LORD and lay His hand on the head of the bull and kill the bull before the LORD.
- 5 *And the priest that is anointed shall take of the bullock's blood, and bring it to the tabernacle of the congregation:*

the anointed priest shall take some of the blood of the bull and bring it into the tent of meeting,
- 6 *And the priest shall dip his finger in the blood, and sprinkle of the blood seven times before the LORD, before the veil of the sanctuary.*

the priest shall dip his finger in the blood and sprinkle part of the blood seven times before the LORD in front of the veil of the sanctuary.

- 7 *And the priest shall put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar of sweet incense before the LORD, which is in the tabernacle of the congregation; and shall pour all the blood of the bullock at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering, which is at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* the priest shall put some of the blood on the horns of the altar of fragrant incense before the LORD that is in the tent of meeting. All the rest of the blood of the bull He shall pour out at the base of the altar of burnt offering that is at the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 8 *And he shall take off from it all the fat of the bullock for the sin offering; the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,* all the fat of the bull of the sin offering He shall remove from it, the fat that covers the entrails and all the fat that is on the entrails
- 9 *And the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away,* the two kidneys with the fat that is on them at the loins and the long lobe of the liver that He shall remove with the kidneys
- 10 *As it was taken off from the bullock of the sacrifice of peace offerings: and the priest shall burn them upon the altar of the burnt offering.* (just as these are taken from the ox of the sacrifice of the peace offerings). The priest shall burn them on the altar of burnt offering.
- 11 *And the skin of the bullock, and all his flesh, with his head, and with his legs, and his inwards, and his dung,* But the skin of the bull and all its flesh, with its head, its legs, its entrails, and its dung —
- 12 *Even the whole bullock shall he carry forth without the camp unto a clean place, where the ashes are poured out, and burn him on the wood with fire: where the ashes are poured out shall he be burnt.* all the rest of the bull — he shall carry outside the camp to a clean place, to the ash heap, and shall burn it up on a fire of wood. On the ash heap it shall be burned up.

- 13 *And if the whole congregation of Israel sin through ignorance, and the thing be hid from the eyes of the assembly, and they have done somewhat against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which should not be done, and are guilty;* If the whole congregation of Israel sins unintentionally and the thing is hidden from the eyes of the assembly, if they do any one of the things that by the LORD's commandments ought not to be done, and they realize their guilt,
- 14 *When the sin, which they have sinned against it, is known, then the congregation shall offer a young bullock for the sin, and bring him before the tabernacle of the congregation.* when the sin which they have committed becomes known, the assembly shall offer a bull from the herd for a sin offering and bring it in front of the tent of meeting.
- 15 *And the elders of the congregation shall lay their hands upon the head of the bullock before the LORD: and the bullock shall be killed before the LORD.* the elders of the congregation shall lay their hands on the head of the bull before the LORD, and the bull shall be killed before the LORD.
- 16 *And the priest that is anointed shall bring of the bullock's blood to the tabernacle of the congregation:* Then the anointed priest shall bring some of the blood of the bull into the tent of meeting,
- 17 *And the priest shall dip his finger in some of the blood, and sprinkle it seven times before the LORD, even before the veil.* the priest shall dip his finger in the blood and sprinkle it seven times before the LORD in front of the veil.
- 18 *And he shall put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar which is before the LORD, that is in the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall pour out all the blood at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering, which is at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* he shall put some of the blood on the horns of the altar that is in the tent of meeting before the LORD, and the rest of the blood He shall pour out at the base of the altar of burnt offering that is at the entrance of the tent of meeting.

- 19 *And he shall take all his fat from him, and burn it upon the altar.* all its fat He shall take from it and burn on the altar.
- 20 *And he shall do with the bullock as he did with the bullock for a sin offering, so shall he do with this: and the priest shall make an atonement for them, and it shall be forgiven them.* Thus shall he do with the bull. As he did with the bull of the sin offering, so shall he do with this. And the priest shall make atonement for them. They shall be forgiven.
- 21 *And he shall carry forth the bullock without the camp, and burn him as he burned the first bullock: it is a sin offering for the congregation.* he shall carry the bull outside the camp and burn it up as he burned the first bull; it is the sin offering for the assembly.
- 22 *When a ruler hath sinned, and done somewhat through ignorance against any of the commandments of the LORD his God concerning things which should not be done, and is guilty;* When a leader sins, doing unintentionally any one of all the things that by the commandments of the LORD His God ought not to be done, and realizes His guilt,
- 23 *Or if his sin, wherein he hath sinned, come to his knowledge; he shall bring his offering, a kid of the goats, a male without blemish:* or the sin which He has committed is made known to Him, He shall bring as His offering a goat, a male without blemish,
- 24 *And he shall lay his hand upon the head of the goat, and kill it in the place where they kill the burnt offering before the LORD: it is a sin offering.* shall lay His hand on the head of the goat and kill it in the place where they kill the burnt offering before the LORD; it is a sin offering.
- 25 *And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out his blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.* Then the priest shall take some of the blood of the sin offering with his finger and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering and pour out the rest of its blood at the base of the altar of burnt offering.

- 26 *And he shall burn all his fat upon the altar, as the fat of the sacrifice of peace offerings: and the priest shall make an atonement for him as concerning his sin, and it shall be forgiven him.* all its fat he shall burn on the altar, like the fat of the sacrifice of peace offerings. So the priest shall make atonement for him for his sin. He shall be forgiven.
- 27 *And if any one of the common people sin through ignorance, while he doeth somewhat against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which ought not to be done, and be guilty;* If anyone of the common people sins unintentionally in doing any one of the things that by the LORD's commandments ought not to be done, and realizes His guilt,
- 28 *Or if his sin, which he hath sinned, come to his knowledge: then he shall bring his offering, a kid of the goats, a female without blemish, for his sin which he hath sinned.* or the sin which He has committed is made known to Him, He shall bring for His offering a goat, a female without blemish, for His sin which He has committed.
- 29 *And he shall lay his hand upon the head of the sin offering, and slay the sin offering in the place of the burnt offering.* he shall lay His hand on the head of the sin offering and kill the sin offering in the place of burnt offering.
- 30 *And the priest shall take of the blood thereof with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out all the blood thereof at the bottom of the altar.* the priest shall take some of its blood with his finger and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering and pour out all the rest of its blood at the base of the altar.
- 31 *And he shall take away all the fat thereof, as the fat is taken away from off the sacrifice of peace offerings; and the priest shall burn it upon the altar for a sweet savour unto the LORD; and the priest shall make an atonement for him, and it shall be forgiven him.* all its fat He shall remove, as the fat is removed from the peace offerings, and the priest shall burn it on the altar for a sweet savour unto the LORD. And the priest shall make atonement for him. He shall be forgiven.

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| <p>32 <i>And if he bring a lamb for a sin offering, he shall bring it a female without blemish.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And he shall lay his hand upon the head of the sin offering, and slay it for a sin offering in the place where they kill the burnt offering.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out all the blood thereof at the bottom of the altar:</i></p> <p>35 <i>And he shall take away all the fat thereof, as the fat of the lamb is taken away from the sacrifice of the peace offerings; and the priest shall burn them upon the altar, according to the offerings made by fire unto the LORD: and the priest shall make an atonement for his sin that he hath committed, and it shall be forgiven him.</i></p> | <p>If He brings a lamb as His offering for a sin offering, He shall bring a female without blemish</p> <p>lay His hand on the head of the sin offering and kill it for a sin offering in the place where they kill the burnt offering.</p> <p>Then the priest shall take some of the blood of the sin offering with his finger and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering and pour out all the rest of its blood at the base of the altar.</p> <p>all its fat He shall remove as the fat of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice of peace offerings, and the priest shall burn it on the altar, on top of the LORD's offerings made by fire. And the priest shall make atonement for him for the sin which He has committed. He shall be forgiven.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 19:12

v3 — Heb 7:27-28

v7 — Lev 8:15; Lev 9:9; Lev 16:18; Lev 4:34; Lev 4:18

v11 — Num 19:5

v12 — Heb 13:11

v13 — Lev 5:17

v25 — Lev 4:30; Lev 4:34; Lev 4:18; Lev 4:7

v27 — Lev 4:2; Num 15:27

v28 — Lev 4:23

v29 — Lev 4:24; Lev 4:4

v31 — Lev 4:26; Lev 4:35

v32 — Lev 4:28

Chapter 5

The LORD gives laws concerning guilt offerings for specific sins: failing to testify, touching unclean things, and rash oaths. Provision is made for the poor to bring birds or even flour instead of a lamb, and a ram is required for trespasses against the LORD's holy things.

- 1 *And if a soul sin, and hear the voice of swearing, and is a witness, whether he hath seen or known of it; if he do not utter it, then he shall bear his iniquity.* If anyone sins in that he hears a public adjuration to testify, and though He is a witness, whether He has seen or come to know the matter, yet does not speak, He shall bear His iniquity;
- 2 *Or if a soul touch any unclean thing, whether it be a carcase of an unclean beast, or a carcase of unclean cattle, or the carcase of unclean creeping things, and if it be hidden from him; he also shall be unclean, and guilty.* or if anyone touches an unclean thing, whether a carcass of an unclean wild animal or a carcass of unclean livestock or a carcass of unclean swarming things. and if it be hidden from Him, He also shall be unclean and guilty.
- 3 *Or if he touch the uncleanness of man, whatsoever uncleanness it be that a man shall be defiled withal, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then he shall be guilty.* or if He touches human uncleanness, of whatever sort the uncleanness may be with which one becomes unclean. It is hidden from Him, when He comes to know it, and realizes His guilt;

- 4 *Or if a soul swear, pronouncing with his lips to do evil, or to do good, whatsoever it be that a man shall pronounce with an oath, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then he shall be guilty in one of these.* or if anyone utters with his lips a rash oath to do evil or to do good, any sort of rash oath that people swear. It is hidden from Him, when He comes to know it. He realizes His guilt in any of these;
- 5 *And it shall be, when he shall be guilty in one of these things, that he shall confess that he hath sinned in that thing:* when He realizes His guilt in any of these and confesses the sin He has committed,
- 6 *And he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD for his sin which he hath sinned, a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats, for a sin offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for him concerning his sin.* he shall bring to the LORD as His compensation for the sin that He has committed, a female from the flock, a lamb or a goat, for a sin offering. And the priest shall make atonement for him for his sin.
- 7 *And if he be not able to bring a lamb, then he shall bring for his trespass, which he hath committed, two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, unto the LORD; one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering.* But if He cannot afford a lamb, then He shall bring to the LORD as His compensation for the sin that He has committed two turtledoves or two pigeons, one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering.
- 8 *And he shall bring them unto the priest, who shall offer that which is for the sin offering first, and wring off his head from his neck, but shall not divide it asunder:* He shall bring them to the priest, who shall offer first the one for the sin offering. He shall wring its head from its neck, but shall not sever it completely,
- 9 *And he shall sprinkle of the blood of the sin offering upon the side of the altar; and the rest of the blood shall be wrung out at the bottom of the altar: it is a sin offering.* he shall sprinkle some of the blood of the sin offering on the side of the altar, while the rest of the blood shall be drained out at the base of the altar; it is a sin offering.

- 10 *And he shall offer the second for a burnt offering, according to the manner: and the priest shall make an atonement for him for his sin which he hath sinned, and it shall be forgiven him.* Then he shall offer the second for a burnt offering according to the rule. And the priest shall make atonement for him for the sin that he has committed. He shall be forgiven.
- 11 *But if he be not able to bring two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, then he that sinned shall bring for his offering the tenth part of an ephah of fine flour for a sin offering; he shall put no oil upon it, neither shall he put any frankincense thereon: for it is a sin offering.* But if he cannot afford two turtledoves or two pigeons, then he shall bring as his offering for the sin that he has committed a tenth of an ephah of fine flour for a sin offering. He shall put no oil on it and shall put no frankincense on it, for it is a sin offering.
- 12 *Then shall he bring it to the priest, and the priest shall take his handful of it, even a memorial thereof, and burn it on the altar, according to the offerings made by fire unto the LORD: it is a sin offering.* he shall bring it to the priest, and the priest shall take a handful of it as its memorial portion and burn this on the altar, on the LORD's offerings made by fire; it is a sin offering.
- 13 *And the priest shall make an atonement for him as touching his sin that he hath sinned in one of these, and it shall be forgiven him: and the remnant shall be the priest's, as a meat offering.* Thus the priest shall make atonement for him for the sin which he has committed in any one of these things. He shall be forgiven. And the remainder shall be for the priest, as in the grain offering.'
- 14 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 15 *If a soul commit a trespass, and sin through ignorance, in the holy things of the LORD; then he shall bring for his trespass unto the LORD a ram without blemish out of the flocks, with thy estimation by shekels of silver, after the shekel of the sanctuary, for a trespass offering:* 'If anyone commits a breach of faith and sins unintentionally in any of the holy things of the LORD, He shall bring to the LORD as His compensation, a ram without blemish out of the flock, valued in silver shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, for a guilt offering.
- 16 *And he shall make amends for the harm that he hath done in the holy thing, and shall add the fifth part thereto, and give it unto the priest: and the priest shall make an atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering, and it shall be forgiven him.* He shall also make restitution for what he has done wrong in the holy thing and shall add a fifth to it and give it to the priest. And the priest shall make atonement for him with the ram of the guilt offering. He shall be forgiven.
- 17 *And if a soul sin, and commit any of these things which are forbidden to be done by the commandments of the LORD; though he wist it not, yet is he guilty, and shall bear his iniquity.* If anyone sins, doing any of the things that by the LORD's commandments ought not to be done, though He did not know it, then realizes His guilt, He shall bear His iniquity.
- 18 *And he shall bring a ram without blemish out of the flock, with thy estimation, for a trespass offering, unto the priest: and the priest shall make an atonement for him concerning his ignorance wherein he erred and wist it not, and it shall be forgiven him.* He shall bring to the priest a ram without blemish out of the flock, or its equivalent, for a guilt offering, and the priest shall make atonement for him for the mistake that he made unintentionally. He shall be forgiven.
- 19 *It is a trespass offering: he hath certainly trespassed against the LORD.* It is a guilt offering: He has indeed incurred guilt before the LORD.'

Words in this chapter:

trespass offering — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Lev 5:17; Prov 29:24
v2 — Lev 5:17
v4 — Eccl 5:2-6
v5 — Prov 28:13; Num 5:7; Lev 26:40; Lev 16:21
v6 — Lev 4:32; Lev 4:28
v7 — Lev 12:8
v9 — Lev 4:7; Lev 4:18; Lev 4:30; Lev 4:34
v10 — Lev 1:14-17; Lev 4:26
v11 — Num 5:15
v15 — Ex 30:13
v16 — Num 5:7; Lev 22:14
v17 — Lev 4:27; Lev 4:13; Ps 19:12; Lev 4:2-4

Chapter 6

The LORD gives laws requiring restitution plus a fifth for sins of dishonesty against a neighbor. He then gives the priests detailed instructions for maintaining the perpetual fire on the altar and for properly handling the burnt offering, grain offering, and sin offering.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| <p>2 <i>If a soul sin, and commit a trespass against the LORD, and lie unto his neighbour in that which was delivered him to keep, or in fellowship, or in a thing taken away by violence, or hath deceived his neighbour;</i></p> | 'If anyone sins and commits a breach of faith against the LORD by deceiving His neighbor in a matter of deposit or security, or through robbery, or if He has oppressed His neighbor |
| <p>3 <i>Or have found that which was lost, and lieth concerning it, and sweareth falsely; in any of all these that a man doeth, sinning therein:</i></p> | or has found something lost and lied about it, swearing falsely — in any of all the things that people do and sin thereby — |
| <p>4 <i>Then it shall be, because he hath sinned, and is guilty, that he shall restore that which he took violently away, or the thing which he hath deceitfully gotten, or that which was delivered him to keep, or the lost thing which he found,</i></p> | if He has sinned and has realized His guilt and will restore what He took by robbery or what He got by oppression or the deposit that was committed to Him or the lost thing that He found |

- 5 *Or all that about which he hath sworn falsely; he shall even restore it in the principal, and shall add the fifth part more thereto, and give it unto him to whom it appertaineth, in the day of his trespass offering.* or anything about which He has sworn falsely, He shall restore it in full and shall add a fifth to it, and give it to Him to whom it belongs on the day He realizes His guilt.
- 6 *And he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD, a ram without blemish out of the flock, with thy estimation, for a trespass offering, unto the priest:* he shall bring to the priest as his compensation to the LORD a ram without blemish out of the flock, or its equivalent, for a guilt offering.
- 7 *And the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD: and it shall be forgiven him for any thing of all that he hath done in trespassing therein.* the priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD. He shall be forgiven for any of the things that one may do and thereby become guilty.'
- 8 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 9 *Command Aaron and his sons, saying, This is the law of the burnt offering: It is the burnt offering, because of the burning upon the altar all night unto the morning, and the fire of the altar shall be burning in it.* 'Command Aaron and his sons, saying, This is the law of the burnt offering. The burnt offering shall be on the hearth on the altar all night until the morning, and the fire of the altar shall be kept burning on it.
- 10 *And the priest shall put on his linen garment, and his linen breeches shall he put upon his flesh, and take up the ashes which the fire hath consumed with the burnt offering on the altar, and he shall put them beside the altar.* the priest shall put on his linen garment and put his linen undergarment on his body. He shall take up the ashes to which the fire has reduced the burnt offering on the altar and put them beside the altar.
- 11 *And he shall put off his garments, and put on other garments, and carry forth the ashes without the camp unto a clean place.* Then he shall take off his garments and put on other garments and carry the ashes outside the camp to a clean place.

- 12 *And the fire upon the altar shall be burning in it; it shall not be put out: and the priest shall burn wood on it every morning, and lay the burnt offering in order upon it; and he shall burn thereon the fat of the peace offerings.* The fire on the altar shall be kept burning on it; it shall not go out. The priest shall burn wood on it every morning. He shall arrange the burnt offering on it and shall burn on it the fat of the peace offerings.
- 13 *The fire shall ever be burning upon the altar; it shall never go out.* Fire shall be kept burning on the altar continually; it shall not go out.
- 14 *And this is the law of the meat offering: the sons of Aaron shall offer it before the LORD, before the altar.* this is the law of the grain offering. The sons of Aaron shall offer it before the LORD in front of the altar.
- 15 *And he shall take of it his handful, of the flour of the meat offering, and of the oil thereof, and all the frankincense which is upon the meat offering, and shall burn it upon the altar for a sweet savour, even the memorial of it, unto the LORD.* one shall take from it a handful of the fine flour of the grain offering and of its oil and all of the frankincense that is on the grain offering, and shall burn this as its memorial portion on the altar, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 16 *And the remainder thereof shall Aaron and his sons eat: with unleavened bread shall it be eaten in the holy place; in the court of the tabernacle of the congregation they shall eat it.* the rest of it Aaron and his sons shall eat. It shall be eaten unleavened in a holy place. In the court of the tent of meeting they shall eat it.
- 17 *It shall not be baken with leaven. I have given it unto them for their portion of my offerings made by fire; it is most holy, as is the sin offering, and as the trespass offering.* It shall not be baked with leaven. I have given it as their portion of my offerings made by fire. It is a thing most holy, like the sin offering and the guilt offering.

- 18 *All the males among the children of Aaron shall eat of it. It shall be a statute for ever in your generations concerning the offerings of the LORD made by fire: every one that toucheth them shall be holy.* Every male among the children of Aaron may eat of it, as decreed forever throughout Your generations, from the LORD's offerings made by fire. Whatever touches them shall become holy.'
- 19 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 20 *This is the offering of Aaron and of his sons, which they shall offer unto the LORD in the day when he is anointed; the tenth part of an ephah of fine flour for a meat offering perpetual, half of it in the morning, and half thereof at night.* 'This is the offering that Aaron and his sons shall offer to the LORD on the day when He is anointed: a tenth of an ephah of fine flour as a regular grain offering, half of it in the morning and half in the evening.
- 21 *In a pan it shall be made with oil; and when it is baken, thou shalt bring it in: and the baken pieces of the meat offering shalt thou offer for a sweet savour unto the LORD.* It shall be made with oil on a griddle. You shall bring it well mixed, in baked pieces like a grain offering, and offer it for a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 22 *And the priest of his sons that is anointed in his stead shall offer it: it is a statute for ever unto the LORD; it shall be wholly burnt.* The priest from among Aaron's sons, who is anointed to succeed him, shall offer it to the LORD as decreed forever. The whole of it shall be burned.
- 23 *For every meat offering for the priest shall be wholly burnt: it shall not be eaten.* Every grain offering of a priest shall be wholly burned. It shall not be eaten.'
- 24 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

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| <p>25 <i>Speak unto Aaron and to his sons, saying, This is the law of the sin offering: In the place where the burnt offering is killed shall the sin offering be killed before the LORD: it is most holy.</i></p> <p>26 <i>The priest that offereth it for sin shall eat it: in the holy place shall it be eaten, in the court of the tabernacle of the congregation.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Whatsoever shall touch the flesh thereof shall be holy: and when there is sprinkled of the blood thereof upon any garment, thou shalt wash that whereon it was sprinkled in the holy place.</i></p> <p>28 <i>But the earthen vessel wherein it is sodden shall be broken: and if it be sodden in a brasen pot, it shall be both scoured, and rinsed in water.</i></p> <p>29 <i>All the males among the priests shall eat thereof: it is most holy.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And no sin offering, whereof any of the blood is brought into the tabernacle of the congregation to reconcile withal in the holy place, shall be eaten: it shall be burnt in the fire.</i></p> | <p>'Speak to Aaron and his sons, saying, This is the law of the sin offering. In the place where the burnt offering is killed shall the sin offering be killed before the LORD; it is most holy.</p> <p>The priest who offers it for sin shall eat it. In a holy place it shall be eaten, in the court of the tent of meeting.</p> <p>Whatever touches its flesh shall be holy, and when any of its blood is splashed on a garment, you shall wash that on which it was splashed in a holy place.</p> <p>the earthenware vessel in which it is boiled shall be broken. But if it is boiled in a bronze vessel, that shall be scoured and rinsed in water.</p> <p>Every male among the priests may eat of it; it is most holy.</p> <p>But no sin offering shall be eaten from which any blood is brought into the tent of meeting to make atonement in the Holy Place; it shall be burned up with fire.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

trespass offering — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Aaron (AIR-on) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Lev 5:15
- v7 — Lev 4:26
- v12 — Lev 9:24; Ex 29:38-42
- v15 — Lev 2:9; Lev 2:2
- v16 — Lev 2:3; Ezek 44:29
- v21 — Lev 2:5
- v25 — Lev 4:24; Lev 1:11
- v26 — Lev 10:17-18
- v28 — Lev 11:33; Lev 15:12

Chapter 7

The LORD completes the laws of the offerings, detailing how the guilt offering and peace offering are to be handled. He forbids eating fat or blood under penalty of being cut off, and assigns the breast and right thigh of the peace offering to the priests as their perpetual portion.

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| 1 | <i>Likewise this is the law of the trespass offering: it is most holy.</i> | This is the law of the guilt offering. It is most holy. |
| 2 | <i>In the place where they kill the burnt offering shall they kill the trespass offering: and the blood thereof shall he sprinkle round about upon the altar.</i> | In the place where they kill the burnt offering they shall kill the guilt offering, and its blood shall be thrown against the sides of the altar. |
| 3 | <i>And he shall offer of it all the fat thereof; the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards,</i> | all its fat shall be offered, the fat tail, the fat that covers the entrails, |
| 4 | <i>And the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the flanks, and the caul that is above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away:</i> | the two kidneys with the fat that is on them at the loins, and the long lobe of the liver that He shall remove with the kidneys. |

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| 5 | <i>And the priest shall burn them upon the altar for an offering made by fire unto the LORD: it is a trespass offering.</i> | The priest shall burn them on the altar as a offering made by fire to the LORD; it is a guilt offering. |
| 6 | <i>Every male among the priests shall eat thereof: it shall be eaten in the holy place: it is most holy.</i> | Every male among the priests may eat of it. It shall be eaten in a holy place. It is most holy. |
| 7 | <i>As the sin offering is, so is the trespass offering: there is one law for them: the priest that maketh atonement therewith shall have it.</i> | The guilt offering is just like the sin offering; there is one law for them. The priest who makes atonement with it shall have it. |
| 8 | <i>And the priest that offereth any man's burnt offering, even the priest shall have to himself the skin of the burnt offering which he hath offered.</i> | the priest who offers any man's burnt offering shall have for himself the skin of the burnt offering that he has offered. |
| 9 | <i>And all the meat offering that is baked in the oven, and all that is dressed in the fryingpan, and in the pan, shall be the priest's that offereth it.</i> | every grain offering baked in the oven and all that is prepared on a pan or a griddle shall belong to the priest who offers it. |
| 10 | <i>And every meat offering, mingled with oil, and dry, shall all the sons of Aaron have, one as much as another.</i> | every grain offering, mixed with oil or dry, shall be shared equally among all the sons of Aaron. |
| 11 | <i>And this is the law of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which he shall offer unto the LORD.</i> | this is the law of the sacrifice of peace offerings that one may offer to the LORD. |
| 12 | <i>If he offer it for a thanksgiving, then he shall offer with the sacrifice of thanksgiving unleavened cakes mingled with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed with oil, and cakes mingled with oil, of fine flour, fried.</i> | If He offers it for a thanksgiving, then He shall offer with the thanksgiving sacrifice unleavened loaves mixed with oil, unleavened wafers smeared with oil, and loaves of fine flour well mixed with oil. |

- 13 *Besides the cakes, he shall offer for his offering leavened bread with the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings.* With the sacrifice of His peace offerings for thanksgiving He shall bring His offering with loaves of leavened bread.
- 14 *And of it he shall offer one out of the whole oblation for an heave offering unto the LORD, and it shall be the priest's that sprinkleth the blood of the peace offerings.* from it He shall offer one loaf from each offering, as a gift to the LORD. It shall belong to the priest who throws the blood of the peace offerings.
- 15 *And the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings for thanksgiving shall be eaten the same day that it is offered; he shall not leave any of it until the morning.* the flesh of the sacrifice of His peace offering for thanksgiving shall be eaten on the day of His offering. He shall not leave any of it until the morning.
- 16 *But if the sacrifice of his offering be a vow, or a voluntary offering, it shall be eaten the same day that he offereth his sacrifice: and on the morrow also the remainder of it shall be eaten:* But if the sacrifice of His offering is a vow or a freewill offering, it shall be eaten on the day that He offers His sacrifice, and on the next day what remains of it shall be eaten.
- 17 *But the remainder of the flesh of the sacrifice on the third day shall be burnt with fire.* But what remains of the flesh of the sacrifice on the third day shall be burned up with fire.
- 18 *And if any of the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings be eaten at all on the third day, it shall not be accepted, neither shall it be imputed unto him that offereth it: it shall be an abomination, and the soul that eateth of it shall bear his iniquity.* If any of the flesh of the sacrifice of His peace offering is eaten on the third day, He who offers it shall not be accepted, neither shall it be credited to Him. It is tainted. He who eats of it shall bear his iniquity.
- 19 *And the flesh that toucheth any unclean thing shall not be eaten; it shall be burnt with fire: and as for the flesh, all that be clean shall eat thereof.* Flesh that touches any unclean thing shall not be eaten. It shall be burned up with fire. All who are clean may eat flesh,

- 20 *But the soul that eateth of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings, that pertain unto the LORD, having his uncleanness upon him, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.* but the person who eats of the flesh of the sacrifice of the LORD's peace offerings while He is unclean, that person shall be cut off from His people.
- 21 *Moreover the soul that shall touch any unclean thing, as the uncleanness of man, or any unclean beast, or any abominable unclean thing, and eat of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which pertain unto the LORD, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.* if anyone touches an unclean thing, whether human uncleanness or an unclean beast or any unclean detestable creature, and then eats some flesh from the sacrifice of the LORD's peace offerings, that person shall be cut off from His people.
- 22 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 23 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, Ye shall eat no manner of fat, of ox, or of sheep, or of goat.* 'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, You shall eat no fat, of ox or sheep or goat.
- 24 *And the fat of the beast that dieth of itself, and the fat of that which is torn with beasts, may be used in any other use: but ye shall in no wise eat of it.* The fat of an animal that dies of itself and the fat of one that is torn by beasts may be put to any other use, but on no account shall You eat it.
- 25 *For whosoever eateth the fat of the beast, of which men offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD, even the soul that eateth it shall be cut off from his people.* For every person who eats of the fat of an animal of which a offering made by fire may be made to the LORD shall be cut off from His people.
- 26 *Moreover ye shall eat no manner of blood, whether it be of fowl or of beast, in any of your dwellings.* Moreover, You shall eat no blood whatever, whether of fowl or of animal, in any of Your dwelling places.
- 27 *Whatsoever soul it be that eateth any manner of blood, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.* Whoever eats any blood, that person shall be cut off from His people.'

- 28 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 29 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, He that offereth the sacrifice of his peace offerings unto the LORD shall bring his oblation unto the LORD of the sacrifice of his peace offerings.* 'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, Whoever offers the sacrifice of his peace offerings to the LORD shall bring His offering to the LORD from the sacrifice of His peace offerings.
- 30 *His own hands shall bring the offerings of the LORD made by fire, the fat with the breast, it shall he bring, that the breast may be waved for a wave offering before the LORD.* His own hands shall bring the LORD's offerings made by fire. He shall bring the fat with the breast, that the breast may be waved as a wave offering before the LORD.
- 31 *And the priest shall burn the fat upon the altar: but the breast shall be Aaron's and his sons'.* The priest shall burn the fat on the altar, but the breast shall be for Aaron and his sons.
- 32 *And the right shoulder shall ye give unto the priest for an heave offering of the sacrifices of your peace offerings.* the right thigh you shall give to the priest as a contribution from the sacrifice of your peace offerings.
- 33 *He among the sons of Aaron, that offereth the blood of the peace offerings, and the fat, shall have the right shoulder for his part.* Whoever among the sons of Aaron offers the blood of the peace offerings and the fat shall have the right thigh for a portion.
- 34 *For the wave breast and the heave shoulder have I taken of the children of Israel from off the sacrifices of their peace offerings, and have given them unto Aaron the priest and unto his sons by a statute for ever from among the children of Israel.* For the breast that is waved and the thigh that is contributed I have taken from the children of Israel, out of the sacrifices of their peace offerings, and have given them to Aaron the priest and to his sons, as a perpetual due from the children of Israel.

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| <p>35 <i>This is the portion of the anointing of Aaron, and of the anointing of his sons, out of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, in the day when he presented them to minister unto the LORD in the priest's office;</i></p> <p>36 <i>Which the LORD commanded to be given them of the children of Israel, in the day that he anointed them, by a statute for ever throughout their generations.</i></p> <p>37 <i>This is the law of the burnt offering, of the meat offering, and of the sin offering, and of the trespass offering, and of the consecrations, and of the sacrifice of the peace offerings;</i></p> <p>38 <i>Which the LORD commanded Moses in mount Sinai, in the day that he commanded the children of Israel to offer their oblations unto the LORD, in the wilderness of Sinai.</i></p> | <p>This is the portion of Aaron and of his sons from the LORD's offerings made by fire, from the day they were presented to serve as priests of the LORD.</p> <p>The LORD commanded this to be given them by the children of Israel, from the day that He anointed them. It is a perpetual due throughout their generations.</p> <p>This is the law of the burnt offering, of the grain offering, of the sin offering, of the guilt offering, of the ordination offering, and of the peace offering,</p> <p>which the LORD commanded Moses on Mount Sinai, on the day that he commanded the children of Israel to bring their offerings to the LORD, in the wilderness of Sinai.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

imputed — Credited to your account — our sin charged to Christ, His righteousness counted as ours.

Sinai (SY-ny) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

v12 — Num 6:15; Lev 2:4

v13 — Amos 4:5

v14 — Num 18:19

v18 — Lev 19:7-8

v23 — Lev 3:16-17

v24 — Ex 22:31

v26 — Gen 9:4

v32 — Lev 9:21; Num 6:20; Lev 7:34

v36 — Lev 8:12

Chapter 8

Moses consecrates Aaron and his sons as priests before the whole congregation. He washes them, clothes Aaron in the priestly garments, anoints the tabernacle and altar with oil, and offers a bull and two rams for their ordination over seven days.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Take Aaron and his sons with him, and the garments, and the anointing oil, and a bullock for the sin offering, and two rams, and a basket of unleavened bread;</i> | "Take Aaron and his sons with him, and the garments and the anointing oil and the bull of the sin offering and the two rams and the basket of unleavened bread. |
| 3 | <i>And gather thou all the congregation together unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.</i> | assemble all the congregation at the entrance of the tent of meeting.' |
| 4 | <i>And Moses did as the LORD commanded him; and the assembly was gathered together unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.</i> | Moses did as the LORD commanded Him, and the congregation was assembled at the entrance of the tent of meeting. |
| 5 | <i>And Moses said unto the congregation, This is the thing which the LORD commanded to be done.</i> | Moses said to the congregation, 'This is the thing that the LORD has commanded to be done.' |
| 6 | <i>And Moses brought Aaron and his sons, and washed them with water.</i> | Moses brought Aaron and his sons and washed them with water. |
| 7 | <i>And he put upon him the coat, and girded him with the girdle, and clothed him with the robe, and put the ephod upon him, and he girded him with the curious girdle of the ephod, and bound it unto him therewith.</i> | he put the coat on him and tied the sash around his waist and clothed him with the robe and put the ephod on him and tied the skillfully woven band of the ephod around him, binding it to him with the band. |
| 8 | <i>And he put the breastplate upon him: also he put in the breastplate the Urim and the Thummim.</i> | he placed the breastpiece on him, and in the breastpiece he put the Urim and the Thummim. |

- 9 *And he put the mitre upon his head; also upon the mitre, even upon his forefront, did he put the golden plate, the holy crown; as the LORD commanded Moses.* he set the turban on His head, and on the turban, in front, He set the golden plate, the holy crown, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 10 *And Moses took the anointing oil, and anointed the tabernacle and all that was therein, and sanctified them.* Then Moses took the anointing oil and anointed the tabernacle and all that was in it, and consecrated them.
- 11 *And he sprinkled thereof upon the altar seven times, and anointed the altar and all his vessels, both the laver and his foot, to sanctify them.* he sprinkled some of it on the altar seven times, and anointed the altar and all its utensils and the basin and its stand, to consecrate them.
- 12 *And he poured of the anointing oil upon Aaron's head, and anointed him, to sanctify him.* he poured some of the anointing oil on Aaron's head and anointed him to consecrate him.
- 13 *And Moses brought Aaron's sons, and put coats upon them, and girded them with girdles, and put bonnets upon them; as the LORD commanded Moses.* Moses brought Aaron's sons and clothed them with coats and tied sashes around their waists and bound caps on them, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 14 *And he brought the bullock for the sin offering: and Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the bullock for the sin offering.* Then he brought the bull of the sin offering, and Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the bull of the sin offering.
- 15 *And he slew it; and Moses took the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about with his finger, and purified the altar, and poured the blood at the bottom of the altar, and sanctified it, to make reconciliation upon it.* he killed it, and Moses took the blood, and with his finger put it on the horns of the altar around it and purified the altar and poured out the blood at the base of the altar and consecrated it to make atonement for it.

- 16 *And he took all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat, and Moses burned it upon the altar.* he took all the fat that was on the entrails and the long lobe of the liver and the two kidneys with their fat, and Moses burned them on the altar.
- 17 *But the bullock, and his hide, his flesh, and his dung, he burnt with fire without the camp; as the LORD commanded Moses.* But the bull and its skin and its flesh and its dung He burned up with fire outside the camp, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 18 *And he brought the ram for the burnt offering: and Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram.* Then he presented the ram of the burnt offering, and Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the ram.
- 19 *And he killed it; and Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.* he killed it, and Moses threw the blood against the sides of the altar.
- 20 *And he cut the ram into pieces; and Moses burnt the head, and the pieces, and the fat.* He cut the ram into pieces, and Moses burned the head and the pieces and the fat.
- 21 *And he washed the inwards and the legs in water; and Moses burnt the whole ram upon the altar: it was a burnt sacrifice for a sweet savour, and an offering made by fire unto the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.* He washed the entrails and the legs with water, and Moses burned the whole ram on the altar. It was a burnt offering with a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 22 *And he brought the other ram, the ram of consecration: and Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram.* Then he presented the other ram, the ram of ordination, and Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the ram.
- 23 *And he slew it; and Moses took of the blood of it, and put it upon the tip of Aaron's right ear, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot.* he killed it, and Moses took some of its blood and put it on the lobe of Aaron's right ear and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot.

- 24 *And he brought Aaron's sons, and Moses put of the blood upon the tip of their right ear, and upon the thumbs of their right hands, and upon the great toes of their right feet: and Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.* Then he presented Aaron's sons, and Moses put some of the blood on the lobes of their right ears and on the thumbs of their right hands and on the big toes of their right feet. And Moses threw the blood against the sides of the altar.
- 25 *And he took the fat, and the rump, and all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat, and the right shoulder:* Then he took the fat and the fat tail and all the fat that was on the entrails and the long lobe of the liver and the two kidneys with their fat and the right thigh,
- 26 *And out of the basket of unleavened bread, that was before the LORD, he took one unleavened cake, and a cake of oiled bread, and one wafer, and put them on the fat, and upon the right shoulder:* out of the basket of unleavened bread that was before the LORD He took one unleavened loaf and one loaf of bread with oil and one wafer and placed them on the pieces of fat and on the right thigh.
- 27 *And he put all upon Aaron's hands, and upon his sons' hands, and waved them for a wave offering before the LORD.* he put all these in the hands of Aaron and in the hands of his sons and waved them as a wave offering before the LORD.
- 28 *And Moses took them from off their hands, and burnt them on the altar upon the burnt offering: they were consecrations for a sweet savour: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* Then Moses took them from their hands and burned them on the altar with the burnt offering. This was an ordination offering with a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 29 *And Moses took the breast, and waved it for a wave offering before the LORD: for of the ram of consecration it was Moses' part; as the LORD commanded Moses.* Moses took the breast and waved it for a wave offering before the LORD. It was Moses' portion of the ram of ordination, as the LORD commanded Moses.

- 30 *And Moses took of the anointing oil, and of the blood which was upon the altar, and sprinkled it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon his sons' garments with him; and sanctified Aaron, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons' garments with him.* Then Moses took some of the anointing oil and of the blood that was on the altar and sprinkled it on Aaron and his garments, and also on his sons and his sons' garments. So he consecrated Aaron and his garments, and his sons and his sons' garments with him.
- 31 *And Moses said unto Aaron and to his sons, Boil the flesh at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and there eat it with the bread that is in the basket of consecrations, as I commanded, saying, Aaron and his sons shall eat it.* Moses said to Aaron and his sons, 'Boil the flesh at the entrance of the tent of meeting, and there eat it and the bread that is in the basket of ordination offerings, as I commanded, saying, Aaron and his sons shall eat it.
- 32 *And that which remaineth of the flesh and of the bread shall ye burn with fire.* what remains of the flesh and the bread you shall burn up with fire.
- 33 *And ye shall not go out of the door of the tabernacle of the congregation in seven days, until the days of your consecration be at an end: for seven days shall he consecrate you.* you shall not go outside the entrance of the tent of meeting for seven days, until the days of your ordination are completed, for it will take seven days to ordain you.
- 34 *As he hath done this day, so the LORD hath commanded to do, to make an atonement for you.* As has been done today, the LORD has commanded to be done to make atonement for You.
- 35 *Therefore shall ye abide at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation day and night seven days, and keep the charge of the LORD, that ye die not: for so I am commanded.* At the entrance of the tent of meeting You shall remain day and night for seven days, performing what the LORD has charged, so that You do not die, for so I have been commanded.'
- 36 *So Aaron and his sons did all things which the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.* Aaron and his sons did all the things that the LORD commanded by Moses.

Words in this chapter:

Thummim (*THUM-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate alongside the Urim — together they were God's tool for giving yes/no answers to Israel's leaders.

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

breastplate — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

laver (*LAY-ver*) — The large bronze basin in the tabernacle courtyard — priests washed their hands and feet here before approaching God's altar.

mitre (*MY-ter*) — The turban-like headdress worn by the high priest — a fine linen cap with a gold plate on the front engraved 'HOLINESS TO THE LORD.'

Cross-References:

v12 — Ex 30:30; Ps 133:2

v14 — Ezek 43:19

v15 — Lev 4:7

v17 — Lev 4:11-12

v22 — Lev 8:2

v34 — Heb 7:27

v35 — 1 Kgs 2:3; Deut 11:1; Num 9:19; Num 3:7

v36 — Deut 12:32

Chapter 9

On the eighth day Aaron begins his priestly ministry, offering a sin offering and burnt offering for himself and the people. The glory of the LORD appeared to all the people, and fire came out from the LORD and consumed the offering on the altar.

- 1 *And it came to pass on the eighth day, that Moses called Aaron and his sons, and the elders of Israel;* On the eighth day Moses called Aaron and his sons and the elders of Israel,
- 2 *And he said unto Aaron, Take thee a young calf for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without blemish, and offer them before the LORD.* he said to Aaron, "Take for yourself a bull calf for a sin offering and a ram for a burnt offering, both without blemish, and offer them before the LORD.

- 3 *And unto the children of Israel thou shalt speak, saying, Take ye a kid of the goats for a sin offering; and a calf and a lamb, both of the first year, without blemish, for a burnt offering;* say to the children of Israel, Take a male goat for a sin offering, and a calf and a lamb, both a year old without blemish, for a burnt offering,
- 4 *Also a bullock and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before the LORD; and a meat offering mingled with oil: for to day the LORD will appear unto you.* an ox and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before the LORD, and a grain offering mixed with oil, for today the LORD will appear to You.'
- 5 *And they brought that which Moses commanded before the tabernacle of the congregation: and all the congregation drew near and stood before the LORD.* they brought what Moses commanded in front of the tent of meeting. All the congregation drew near and stood before the LORD.
- 6 *And Moses said, This is the thing which the LORD commanded that ye should do: and the glory of the LORD shall appear unto you.* Moses said, 'This is the thing that the LORD commanded You to do, that the glory of the LORD may appear to You.'
- 7 *And Moses said unto Aaron, Go unto the altar, and offer thy sin offering, and thy burnt offering, and make an atonement for thyself, and for the people: and offer the offering of the people, and make an atonement for them; as the LORD commanded.* Then Moses said to Aaron, 'Draw near to the altar and offer your sin offering and your burnt offering and make atonement for yourself and for the people, and bring the offering of the people and make atonement for them, as the LORD has commanded.'
- 8 *Aaron therefore went unto the altar, and slew the calf of the sin offering, which was for himself.* So Aaron drew near to the altar and killed the calf of the sin offering, which was for himself.
- 9 *And the sons of Aaron brought the blood unto him: and he dipped his finger in the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar, and poured out the blood at the bottom of the altar:* the sons of Aaron presented the blood to him. He dipped his finger in the blood and put it on the horns of the altar and poured out the blood at the base of the altar.

- 10 *But the fat, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver of the sin offering, he burnt upon the altar; as the LORD commanded Moses.* But the fat and the kidneys and the long lobe of the liver from the sin offering He burned on the altar, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 11 *And the flesh and the hide he burnt with fire without the camp.* The flesh and the skin He burned up with fire outside the camp.
- 12 *And he slew the burnt offering; and Aaron's sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled round about upon the altar.* Then he killed the burnt offering, and Aaron's sons handed him the blood. He threw it against the sides of the altar.
- 13 *And they presented the burnt offering unto him, with the pieces thereof, and the head: and he burnt them upon the altar.* they handed the burnt offering to him, piece by piece, and the head. He burned them on the altar.
- 14 *And he did wash the inwards and the legs, and burnt them upon the burnt offering on the altar.* he washed the entrails and the legs and burned them with the burnt offering on the altar.
- 15 *And he brought the people's offering, and took the goat, which was the sin offering for the people, and slew it, and offered it for sin, as the first.* Then he presented the people's offering and took the goat of the sin offering that was for the people and killed it and offered it as a sin offering, like the first one.
- 16 *And he brought the burnt offering, and offered it according to the manner.* he presented the burnt offering and offered it according to the rule.
- 17 *And he brought the meat offering, and took an handful thereof, and burnt it upon the altar, beside the burnt sacrifice of the morning.* he presented the grain offering, took a handful of it, and burned it on the altar, besides the burnt offering of the morning.

- 18 *He slew also the bullock and the ram for a sacrifice of peace offerings, which was for the people: and Aaron's sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled upon the altar round about,* Then he killed the ox and the ram, the sacrifice of peace offerings for the people. And Aaron's sons handed him the blood. He threw it against the sides of the altar.
- 19 *And the fat of the bullock and of the ram, the rump, and that which covereth the inwards, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver:* But the fat pieces of the ox and of the ram, the fat tail and that which covers the entrails and the kidneys and the long lobe of the liver —
- 20 *And they put the fat upon the breasts, and he burnt the fat upon the altar:* they put the fat pieces on the breasts. He burned the fat pieces on the altar,
- 21 *And the breasts and the right shoulder Aaron waved for a wave offering before the LORD; as Moses commanded.* but the breasts and the right thigh Aaron waved for a wave offering before the LORD, as Moses commanded.
- 22 *And Aaron lifted up his hand toward the people, and blessed them, and came down from offering of the sin offering, and the burnt offering, and peace offerings.* Then Aaron lifted up his hands toward the people and blessed them. He came down from offering the sin offering and the burnt offering and the peace offerings.
- 23 *And Moses and Aaron went into the tabernacle of the congregation, and came out, and blessed the people: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto all the people.* Moses and Aaron went into the tent of meeting, and when they came out they blessed the people, and the glory of the LORD appeared to all the people.
- 24 *And there came a fire out from before the LORD, and consumed upon the altar the burnt offering and the fat: which when all the people saw, they shouted, and fell on their faces.* fire came out from before the LORD and consumed the burnt offering and the pieces of fat on the altar, and when all the people saw it, they shouted and fell on their faces.

Words in this chapter:

atonement — The payment for sin that brings God and man back together — covering sin so the relationship is restored.

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

v2 — Lev 4:3

v3 — Ezra 6:17

v4 — Ex 29:43

v6 — Lev 9:23

v7 — Heb 5:3

v11 — Lev 4:11-12; Lev 8:17

v17 — Lev 2:1-2

v21 — Lev 7:30-34

v22 — Deut 21:5; Luke 24:50

v23 — Lev 9:6

v24 — Judg 6:21; 1 Kgs 18:38-39; 1 Chr 21:26; Judg 13:19-20; Ex 3:2

Chapter 10

Nadab and Abihu offer unauthorized fire before the LORD, and fire from the LORD consumes them. Moses instructs Aaron not to mourn publicly, the LORD commands the priests not to drink wine when entering the tent of meeting, and Moses rebukes Eleazar and Ithamar for mishandling the sin offering.

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| <p>¹ <i>And Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, took either of them his censer, and put fire therein, and put incense thereon, and offered strange fire before the LORD, which he commanded them not.</i></p> | <p>Now Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, each took his censer and put fire in it and laid incense on it and offered unauthorized fire before the LORD, which He had not commanded them.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And there went out fire from the LORD, and devoured them, and they died before the LORD.</i></p> | <p>fire came out from before the LORD and consumed them. They died before the LORD.</p> |

- 3 *Then Moses said unto Aaron, This is it that the LORD spake, saying, I will be sanctified in them that come nigh me, and before all the people I will be glorified. And Aaron held his peace.* Then Moses said to Aaron, 'This is what the LORD has said: Among those who are near me I will be sanctified, and before all the people I will be glorified.' And Aaron held his peace.
- 4 *And Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and said unto them, Come near, carry your brethren from before the sanctuary out of the camp.* Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and said to them, 'Come near; carry your brothers away from the front of the sanctuary and out of the camp.'
- 5 *So they went near, and carried them in their coats out of the camp; as Moses had said.* So they came near and carried them in their coats out of the camp, as Moses had said.
- 6 *And Moses said unto Aaron, and unto Eleazar and unto Ithamar, his sons, Uncover not your heads, neither rend your clothes; lest ye die, and lest wrath come upon all the people: but let your brethren, the whole house of Israel, bewail the burning which the LORD hath kindled.* Moses said to Aaron and to Eleazar and Ithamar his sons, 'Do not let the hair of your heads hang loose, and do not tear your clothes, lest you die, and wrath come upon all the congregation. But let your brothers, the whole house of Israel, bewail the burning that the LORD has kindled.
- 7 *And ye shall not go out from the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die: for the anointing oil of the LORD is upon you. And they did according to the word of Moses.* do not go outside the entrance of the tent of meeting, lest You die, for the anointing oil of the LORD is upon You.' And they did according to the word of Moses.
- 8 *And the LORD spake unto Aaron, saying,* the LORD spoke to Aaron, saying,
- 9 *Do not drink wine nor strong drink, thou, nor thy sons with thee, when ye go into the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations:* 'Drink no wine or strong drink, You or Your sons with You, when You go into the tent of meeting, lest You die. It shall be a statute forever throughout Your generations.

- 10 *And that ye may put difference between holy and unholy, and between unclean and clean;* You are to distinguish between the holy and the common, and between the unclean and the clean,
- 11 *And that ye may teach the children of Israel all the statutes which the LORD hath spoken unto them by the hand of Moses.* you are to teach the children of Israel all the statutes that the LORD has spoken to them by Moses.'
- 12 *And Moses spake unto Aaron, and unto Eleazar and unto Ithamar, his sons that were left, Take the meat offering that remaineth of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and eat it without leaven beside the altar: for it is most holy:* Moses spoke to Aaron and to Eleazar and Ithamar, his surviving sons, 'Take the grain offering that is left of the LORD's offerings made by fire, and eat it unleavened beside the altar, for it is most holy.
- 13 *And ye shall eat it in the holy place, because it is thy due, and thy sons' due, of the sacrifices of the LORD made by fire: for so I am commanded.* You shall eat it in a holy place, because it is Your due and Your sons' due, from the LORD's offerings made by fire, for so I am commanded.
- 14 *And the wave breast and heave shoulder shall ye eat in a clean place; thou, and thy sons, and thy daughters with thee: for they be thy due, and thy sons' due, which are given out of the sacrifices of peace offerings of the children of Israel.* But the breast that is waved and the thigh that is contributed You shall eat in a clean place, You and Your sons and Your daughters with You, for they are given as Your due and Your sons' due from the sacrifices of the peace offerings of the children of Israel.
- 15 *The heave shoulder and the wave breast shall they bring with the offerings made by fire of the fat, to wave it for a wave offering before the LORD; and it shall be thine, and thy sons' with thee, by a statute for ever; as the LORD hath commanded.* The thigh that is contributed and the breast that is waved they shall bring with the offerings made by fire of the fat pieces, to wave for a wave offering before the LORD. It shall be Yours and Your sons' with You as a due forever, as the LORD has commanded.'

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| <p>16 <i>And Moses diligently sought the goat of the sin offering, and, behold, it was burnt: and he was angry with Eleazar and Ithamar, the sons of Aaron which were left alive, saying,</i></p> <p>17 <i>Wherefore have ye not eaten the sin offering in the holy place, seeing it is most holy, and God hath given it you to bear the iniquity of the congregation, to make atonement for them before the LORD?</i></p> <p>18 <i>Behold, the blood of it was not brought in within the holy place: ye should indeed have eaten it in the holy place, as I commanded.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Aaron said unto Moses, Behold, this day have they offered their sin offering and their burnt offering before the LORD; and such things have befallen me: and if I had eaten the sin offering to day, should it have been accepted in the sight of the LORD?</i></p> <p>20 <i>And when Moses heard that, he was content.</i></p> | <p>Now Moses diligently inquired about the goat of the sin offering. It was burned up! And he was angry with Eleazar and Ithamar, the surviving sons of Aaron, saying,</p> <p>'Why have You not eaten the sin offering in the place of the sanctuary, since it is a thing most holy and has been given to You that You may bear the iniquity of the congregation, to make atonement for them before the LORD?</p> <p>its blood was not brought into the inner part of the sanctuary. You certainly ought to have eaten it in the sanctuary, as I commanded.'</p> <p>Aaron said to Moses, 'Today they have offered their sin offering and their burnt offering before the LORD, and yet such things as these have happened to me! If I had eaten the sin offering today, would the LORD have approved?'</p> <p>when Moses heard that, he approved.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

v1 — Num 26:61; Deut 12:32; Lev 16:12; Num 16:46; Ex 6:23

v2 — Num 26:61; Num 16:35; Lev 9:24

- v3 — Ex 19:22; Isa 49:3; Lev 21:6; Num 20:12; 1 Sam 2:30
 v4 — Ex 6:22
 v7 — Lev 21:12; Acts 10:38; 2 Cor 1:21; Lev 8:30; Lev 8:12
 v9 — Luke 1:15; 1 Tim 3:3; Isa 28:7; Eph 5:18; Titus 1:7
 v10 — Ezek 22:26; 1 Pet 1:14-16; Lev 11:47; Titus 1:15; Ezek 44:23
 v11 — Matt 28:20; Mal 2:7; Neh 8:8; Neh 8:2
 v12 — Lev 21:22
 v14 — Num 18:11
 v15 — Lev 7:34
 v18 — Lev 6:30; Lev 6:26

Chapter 11

The LORD gives laws distinguishing clean from unclean animals. Land animals must chew the cud and have split hooves; water creatures must have fins and scales; specific birds and insects are listed as unclean. Israel is to be holy because the LORD is holy.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and to Aaron, saying unto them,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying to them, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, These are the beasts which ye shall eat among all the beasts that are on the earth:</i> | 'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, These are the living things that You may eat among all the animals that are on the earth. |
| 3 | <i>Whatsoever parteth the hoof, and is clovenfooted, and cheweth the cud, among the beasts, that shall ye eat.</i> | Whatever parts the hoof and is cloven-footed and chews the cud, among the animals, You may eat. |
| 4 | <i>Nevertheless these shall ye not eat of them that chew the cud, or of them that divide the hoof: as the camel, because he cheweth the cud, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.</i> | Nevertheless, among those that chew the cud or part the hoof, You shall not eat these: the camel, because it chews the cud but does not part the hoof, is unclean to You. |
| 5 | <i>And the coney, because he cheweth the cud, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.</i> | the rock badger, because it chews the cud but does not part the hoof, is unclean to You. |
| 6 | <i>And the hare, because he cheweth the cud, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.</i> | the hare, because it chews the cud but does not part the hoof, is unclean to You. |

- 7 *And the swine, though he divide the hoof, and be clovenfooted, yet he cheweth not the cud; he is unclean to you.* the pig, because it parts the hoof and is cloven-footed but does not chew the cud, is unclean to You.
- 8 *Of their flesh shall ye not eat, and their carcase shall ye not touch; they are unclean to you.* You shall not eat any of their flesh, and You shall not touch their carcasses; they are unclean to You.
- 9 *These shall ye eat of all that are in the waters: whatsoever hath fins and scales in the waters, in the seas, and in the rivers, them shall ye eat.* These You may eat, of all that are in the waters. Everything in the waters that has fins and scales, whether in the seas or in the rivers, You may eat.
- 10 *And all that have not fins and scales in the seas, and in the rivers, of all that move in the waters, and of any living thing which is in the waters, they shall be an abomination unto you:* But anything in the seas or the rivers that does not have fins and scales, of the swarming creatures in the waters and of the living creatures that are in the waters, is detestable to You.
- 11 *They shall be even an abomination unto you; ye shall not eat of their flesh, but ye shall have their carcasses in abomination.* They shall remain detestable to You; You shall not eat any of their flesh, and You shall detest their carcasses.
- 12 *Whatsoever hath no fins nor scales in the waters, that shall be an abomination unto you.* Everything in the waters that does not have fins and scales is detestable to You.
- 13 *And these are they which ye shall have in abomination among the fowls; they shall not be eaten, they are an abomination: the eagle, and the ossifrage, and the ospray,* these You shall detest among the birds; they shall not be eaten; they are detestable: the eagle, the ossifrage, and the ospray,
- 14 *And the vulture, and the kite after his kind;* the vulture, and the kite after His kind,
- 15 *Every raven after his kind;* every raven of any kind,

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| <p>16 <i>And the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after his kind,</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the little owl, and the cormorant, and the great owl,</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the swan, and the pelican, and the gier eagle,</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the stork, the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and the bat.</i></p> <p>20 <i>All fowls that creep, going upon all four, shall be an abomination unto you.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Yet these may ye eat of every flying creeping thing that goeth upon all four, which have legs above their feet, to leap withal upon the earth;</i></p> <p>22 <i>Even these of them ye may eat; the locust after his kind, and the bald locust after his kind, and the beetle after his kind, and the grasshopper after his kind.</i></p> <p>23 <i>But all other flying creeping things, which have four feet, shall be an abomination unto you.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And for these ye shall be unclean: whosoever toucheth the carcase of them shall be unclean until the even.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And whosoever beareth ought of the carcase of them shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even.</i></p> | <p>the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after His kind,</p> <p>the little owl, and the cormorant, and the great owl,</p> <p>the swan, and the pelican, and the gier eagle,</p> <p>the stork, the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and the bat.</p> <p>All winged insects that go on all fours are detestable to You.</p> <p>Yet among the winged insects that go on all fours You may eat those that have jointed legs above their feet, with which to hop on the ground.</p> <p>Of them You may eat: the locust of any kind, the bald locust of any kind, the cricket of any kind, and the grasshopper of any kind.</p> <p>But all other winged insects that have four feet are detestable to You.</p> <p>by these You shall become unclean. Whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening,</p> <p>whoever carries any part of their carcass shall wash His clothes and be unclean until the evening.</p> |
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- 26 *The carcases of every beast which divideth the hoof, and is not clovenfooted, nor cheweth the cud, are unclean unto you: every one that toucheth them shall be unclean.* Every animal that parts the hoof but is not cloven-footed or does not chew the cud is unclean to You. Everyone who touches them shall be unclean.
- 27 *And whatsoever goeth upon his paws, among all manner of beasts that go on all four, those are unclean unto you: whoso toucheth their carcase shall be unclean until the even.* all that walk on their paws, among the animals that go on all fours, are unclean to You. Whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening.
- 28 *And he that beareth the carcase of them shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: they are unclean unto you.* he who carries their carcass shall wash his clothes and be unclean until the evening; they are unclean to You.
- 29 *These also shall be unclean unto you among the creeping things that creep upon the earth; the weasel, and the mouse, and the tortoise after his kind,* these are unclean to You among the swarming things that swarm on the ground: the mole rat, the mouse, the great lizard of any kind,
- 30 *And the ferret, and the chameleon, and the lizard, and the snail, and the mole.* the gecko, the monitor lizard, the lizard, the sand lizard, and the chameleon.
- 31 *These are unclean to you among all that creep: whosoever doth touch them, when they be dead, shall be unclean until the even.* These are unclean to You among all that swarm. Whoever touches them when they are dead shall be unclean until the evening.
- 32 *And upon whatsoever any of them, when they are dead, doth fall, it shall be unclean; whether it be any vessel of wood, or raiment, or skin, or sack, whatsoever vessel it be, wherein any work is done, it must be put into water, and it shall be unclean until the even; so it shall be cleansed.* anything on which any of them falls when they are dead shall be unclean, whether it is an article of wood or a garment or a skin or a sack, any article that is used for any purpose. It must be put into water. It shall be unclean until the evening; then it shall be clean.

- 33 *And every earthen vessel, whereinto any of them falleth, whatsoever is in it shall be unclean; and ye shall break it.* if any of them falls into any earthenware vessel, all that is in it shall be unclean, and You shall break it.
- 34 *Of all meat which may be eaten, that on which such water cometh shall be unclean: and all drink that may be drunk in every such vessel shall be unclean.* Any food in it that could be eaten, on which water comes, shall be unclean. And all drink that could be drunk from every such vessel shall be unclean.
- 35 *And every thing whereupon any part of their carcase falleth shall be unclean; whether it be oven, or ranges for pots, they shall be broken down: for they are unclean, and shall be unclean unto you.* everything on which any part of their carcass falls shall be unclean. Whether oven or stove, it shall be broken in pieces. They are unclean and shall remain unclean to You.
- 36 *Nevertheless a fountain or pit, wherein there is plenty of water, shall be clean: but that which toucheth their carcase shall be unclean.* Nevertheless, a spring or a cistern holding water shall be clean, but whoever touches a carcass in them shall be unclean.
- 37 *And if any part of their carcase fall upon any sowing seed which is to be sown, it shall be clean.* if any part of their carcass falls upon any seed grain that is to be sown, it is clean.
- 38 *But if any water be put upon the seed, and any part of their carcase fall thereon, it shall be unclean unto you.* But if water is put on the seed and any part of their carcass falls on it, it is unclean to You.
- 39 *And if any beast, of which ye may eat, die; he that toucheth the carcase thereof shall be unclean until the even.* if any animal which You may eat dies, whoever touches its carcass shall be unclean until the evening,
- 40 *And he that eateth of the carcase of it shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: he also that beareth the carcase of it shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even.* whoever eats of its carcass shall wash his clothes and be unclean until the evening. And whoever carries the carcass shall wash his clothes and be unclean until the evening.

- 41 *And every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth shall be an abomination; it shall not be eaten.* Every swarming thing that swarms on the ground is detestable; it shall not be eaten.
- 42 *Whatsoever goeth upon the belly, and whatsoever goeth upon all four, or whatsoever hath more feet among all creeping things that creep upon the earth, them ye shall not eat; for they are an abomination.* Whatever goes on its belly, and whatever goes on all fours, or whatever has many feet, any swarming thing that swarms on the ground, You shall not eat, for they are detestable.
- 43 *Ye shall not make yourselves abominable with any creeping thing that creepeth, neither shall ye make yourselves unclean with them, that ye should be defiled thereby.* You shall not make yourselves detestable with any swarming thing that swarms, and You shall not defile yourselves with them, and become unclean through them.
- 44 *For I am the LORD your God: ye shall therefore sanctify yourselves, and ye shall be holy; for I am holy: neither shall ye defile yourselves with any manner of creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.* For I am the LORD Your God. Consecrate yourselves therefore, and be holy, for I am holy. You shall not defile yourselves with any swarming thing that crawls on the ground.
- 45 *For I am the LORD that bringeth you up out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: ye shall therefore be holy, for I am holy.* For I am the LORD Who brought You up out of the land of Egypt to be Your God. You shall therefore be holy, for I am holy.
- 46 *This is the law of the beasts, and of the fowl, and of every living creature that moveth in the waters, and of every creature that creepeth upon the earth:* This is the law about beast and bird and every living creature that moves through the waters and every creature that swarms on the ground,
- 47 *To make a difference between the unclean and the clean, and between the beast that may be eaten and the beast that may not be eaten.* to make a distinction between the unclean and the clean and between the living creature that may be eaten and the living creature that may not be eaten.'

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

cuckow (*KOO-koo*) — KJV spelling for the cuckoo — an unclean bird in the Law; some scholars think it refers to the sea gull or short-eared owl.

gier eagle (*GEER EE-gul*) — An unclean bird in the Law — likely the Egyptian vulture; its name comes from the German 'geier' meaning vulture.

lapwing (*LAP-wing*) — An unclean bird in the Law — likely the hoopoe (a crested bird with a long bill); listed in Leviticus 11 and Deuteronomy 14 among birds not to be eaten.

ospray (*OS-pray*) — A large fish-hunting bird of prey forbidden as food in the Law — likely the osprey or a similar eagle-like bird.

ossifrage (*OS-ih-frij*) — A large bird of prey forbidden as food in the Law — likely the bearded vulture or lammergeier; its name means 'bone-breaker.'

Cross-References:

v7 — Deut 14:8; Isa 66:3; Isa 65:4; Isa 66:17

v32 — Lev 15:12

v40 — Ezek 44:31; Lev 22:8; Deut 14:21

v41 — Lev 11:29

v43 — Lev 20:25

v44 — Ex 20:2; 1 Pet 1:15-16; Lev 19:2; Lev 20:7; Lev 20:26

v45 — Lev 11:44; Ex 20:2; Ex 6:7; 1 Pet 1:16; 1 Thess 4:7

v47 — Lev 10:10; Ezek 44:23

Chapter 12

The LORD gives laws concerning purification after childbirth. A woman is unclean seven days after bearing a son and fourteen days after a daughter, followed by additional days of purification, after which she brings a burnt offering and sin offering to the priest.

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| <p>¹ <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> | <p>The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,</p> |
| <p>² <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, If a woman have conceived seed, and born a man child: then she shall be unclean seven days; according to the days of the separation for her infirmity shall she be unclean.</i></p> | <p>'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, If a woman conceives and bears a male child, then she shall be unclean seven days. As at the time of her menstrual impurity, she shall be unclean.</p> |

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| 3 | <i>And in the eighth day the flesh of his foreskin shall be circumcised.</i> | on the eighth day the flesh of His foreskin shall be circumcised. |
| 4 | <i>And she shall then continue in the blood of her purifying three and thirty days; she shall touch no hallowed thing, nor come into the sanctuary, until the days of her purifying be fulfilled.</i> | Then she shall continue for thirty-three days in the blood of her purifying. She shall not touch anything holy, nor come into the sanctuary, until the days of her purifying are completed. |
| 5 | <i>But if she bear a maid child, then she shall be unclean two weeks, as in her separation: and she shall continue in the blood of her purifying threescore and six days.</i> | But if she bears a female child, then she shall be unclean for two weeks, as in her menstrual impurity. And she shall continue in the blood of her purifying for sixty-six days. |
| 6 | <i>And when the days of her purifying are fulfilled, for a son, or for a daughter, she shall bring a lamb of the first year for a burnt offering, and a young pigeon, or a turtledove, for a sin offering, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, unto the priest:</i> | when the days of her purifying are completed, whether for a son or for a daughter, she shall bring to the priest at the entrance of the tent of meeting a lamb a year old for a burnt offering, and a pigeon or a turtledove for a sin offering. |
| 7 | <i>Who shall offer it before the LORD, and make an atonement for her; and she shall be cleansed from the issue of her blood. This is the law for her that hath born a male or a female.</i> | he shall offer it before the LORD and make atonement for her. Then she shall be clean from the flow of her blood. This is the law for her who bears a child, either male or female. |
| 8 | <i>And if she be not able to bring a lamb, then she shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons; the one for the burnt offering, and the other for a sin offering: and the priest shall make an atonement for her, and she shall be clean.</i> | if she cannot afford a lamb, then she shall take two turtledoves or two pigeons, one for a burnt offering and the other for a sin offering. And the priest shall make atonement for her. She shall be clean.' |

Words in this chapter:

atonement — The payment for sin that brings God and man back together — covering sin so the relationship is restored.

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

v2 — Luke 2:22; Lev 15:19

v3 — Luke 2:21; Luke 1:59; John 7:22-23; Gen 17:11-12; Phil 3:5

v8 — Lev 5:7; Lev 4:26

Chapter 13

The LORD gives the priests detailed instructions for diagnosing leprous disease in human skin. The priest examines swellings, eruptions, and spots, quarantining the person for observation; leprous disease is also to be identified in garments of wool, linen, or leather.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying,
- 2 *When a man shall have in the skin of his flesh a rising, a scab, or bright spot, and it be in the skin of his flesh like the plague of leprosy; then he shall be brought unto Aaron the priest, or unto one of his sons the priests:* 'When a person has on the skin of his body a swelling or an eruption or a spot. It turns into a case of leprous disease on the skin of his body, then he shall be brought to Aaron the priest or to one of his sons the priests,
- 3 *And the priest shall look on the plague in the skin of the flesh: and when the hair in the plague is turned white, and the plague in sight be deeper than the skin of his flesh, it is a plague of leprosy: and the priest shall look on him, and pronounce him unclean.* the priest shall examine the diseased area on the skin of his body. And if the hair in the diseased area has turned white and the disease appears to be deeper than the skin of his body, it is a case of leprous disease. When the priest has examined him, he shall pronounce him unclean.

- 4 *If the bright spot be white in the skin of his flesh, and in sight be not deeper than the skin, and the hair thereof be not turned white; then the priest shall shut up him that hath the plague seven days:* But if the spot is white in the skin of his body and appears no deeper than the skin, and the hair in it has not turned white, the priest shall shut up the diseased person for seven days.
- 5 *And the priest shall look on him the seventh day: and, behold, if the plague in his sight be at a stay, and the plague spread not in the skin; then the priest shall shut him up seven days more:* the priest shall examine him on the seventh day, and if in his eyes the disease has not spread in the skin, then the priest shall shut him up for another seven days.
- 6 *And the priest shall look on him again the seventh day: and, behold, if the plague be somewhat dark, and the plague spread not in the skin, the priest shall pronounce him clean: it is but a scab: and he shall wash his clothes, and be clean.* Then the priest shall examine him again on the seventh day, and if the diseased area has faded and the disease has not spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean; it is only an eruption. And he shall wash his clothes and be clean.
- 7 *But if the scab spread much abroad in the skin, after that he hath shewed himself to the priest for his cleansing, he shall be seen of the priest again:* But if the eruption spreads in the skin, after he has shown himself to the priest for his cleansing, he shall appear again before the priest.
- 8 *And if the priest see that, behold, the scab spreadeth in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a leprosy.* the priest shall look, and if the eruption has spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean; it is a leprous disease.
- 9 *When the plague of leprosy is in a man, then he shall be brought unto the priest;* When a man is afflicted with a leprous disease, he shall be brought to the priest,
- 10 *And the priest shall see him: and, behold, if the rising be white in the skin, and it have turned the hair white, and there be quick raw flesh in the rising;* the priest shall look. And if there is a white swelling in the skin that has turned the hair white, and there is raw flesh in the swelling,

- 11 *It is an old leprosy in the skin of his flesh, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean, and shall not shut him up: for he is unclean.* it is a chronic leprous disease in the skin of his body, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. He shall not shut him up, for he is unclean.
- 12 *And if a leprosy break out abroad in the skin, and the leprosy cover all the skin of him that hath the plague from his head even to his foot, wheresoever the priest looketh;* if the leprous disease breaks out in the skin, so that the leprous disease covers all the skin of the diseased person from head to foot, as far as the priest can see,
- 13 *Then the priest shall consider: and, behold, if the leprosy have covered all his flesh, he shall pronounce him clean that hath the plague: it is all turned white: he is clean.* then the priest shall look, and if the leprous disease has covered all his body, he shall pronounce him clean of the disease; it has all turned white. He is clean.
- 14 *But when raw flesh appeareth in him, he shall be unclean.* But when raw flesh appears on him, he shall be unclean.
- 15 *And the priest shall see the raw flesh, and pronounce him to be unclean: for the raw flesh is unclean: it is a leprosy.* the priest shall examine the raw flesh and pronounce him unclean. Raw flesh is unclean, for it is a leprous disease.
- 16 *Or if the raw flesh turn again, and be changed unto white, he shall come unto the priest;* But if the raw flesh recovers and turns white again, then he shall come to the priest,
- 17 *And the priest shall see him: and, behold, if the plague be turned into white; then the priest shall pronounce him clean that hath the plague: he is clean.* the priest shall examine him, and if the disease has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce the diseased person clean; he is clean.
- 18 *The flesh also, in which, even in the skin thereof, was a boil, and is healed,* when there is in the skin of one's body a boil that has healed,
- 19 *And in the place of the boil there be a white rising, or a bright spot, white, and somewhat reddish, and it be shewed to the priest;* in the place of the boil there comes a white swelling or a reddish-white spot, then it shall be shown to the priest.

- 20 *And if, when the priest seeth it, behold, it be in sight lower than the skin, and the hair thereof be turned white; the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a plague of leprosy broken out of the boil.* the priest shall look, and if it appears deeper than the skin and its hair has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is a leprous disease that has broken out in the boil.
- 21 *But if the priest look on it, and, behold, there be no white hairs therein, and if it be not lower than the skin, but be somewhat dark; then the priest shall shut him up seven days:* But if the priest examines it and there is no white hair in it and it is not deeper than the skin, but has faded, then the priest shall shut him up seven days.
- 22 *And if it spread much abroad in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a plague.* if it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean; it is a disease.
- 23 *But if the bright spot stay in his place, and spread not, it is a burning boil; and the priest shall pronounce him clean.* But if the spot remains in one place and does not spread, it is the scar of the boil, and the priest shall pronounce him clean.
- 24 *Or if there be any flesh, in the skin whereof there is a hot burning, and the quick flesh that burneth have a white bright spot, somewhat reddish, or white;* Or, when the body has a burn on its skin and the raw flesh of the burn becomes a spot, reddish-white or white,
- 25 *Then the priest shall look upon it: and, behold, if the hair in the bright spot be turned white, and it be in sight deeper than the skin; it is a leprosy broken out of the burning: wherefore the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is the plague of leprosy.* the priest shall examine it, and if the hair in the spot has turned white and it appears deeper than the skin, then it is a leprous disease that has broken out in the burn. The priest shall pronounce him unclean; it is a leprous disease.

- 26 *But if the priest look on it, and, behold, there be no white hair in the bright spot, and it be no lower than the other skin, but be somewhat dark; then the priest shall shut him up seven days:* But if the priest examines it and there is no white hair in the spot and it is no deeper than the skin, but has faded, the priest shall shut him up seven days.
- 27 *And the priest shall look upon him the seventh day: and if it be spread much abroad in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is the plague of leprosy.* the priest shall examine him the seventh day. If it has spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean; it is a leprous disease.
- 28 *And if the bright spot stay in his place, and spread not in the skin, but it be somewhat dark; it is a rising of the burning, and the priest shall pronounce him clean: for it is an inflammation of the burning.* But if the spot remains in one place and has not spread in the skin, but has faded, it is a swelling from the burn, and the priest shall pronounce him clean, for it is the scar of the burn.
- 29 *If a man or woman have a plague upon the head or the beard;* When a man or woman has a disease on the head or the beard,
- 30 *Then the priest shall see the plague: and, behold, if it be in sight deeper than the skin; and there be in it a yellow thin hair; then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a dry scall, even a leprosy upon the head or beard.* the priest shall examine the disease. And if it appears deeper than the skin, and the hair in it is yellow and thin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is an itch, a leprous disease of the head or the beard.
- 31 *And if the priest look on the plague of the scall, and, behold, it be not in sight deeper than the skin, and that there is no black hair in it; then the priest shall shut up him that hath the plague of the scall seven days:* if the priest examines the itching disease and it appears no deeper than the skin and there is no black hair in it, then the priest shall shut up the person with the itching disease for seven days.

- 32 *And in the seventh day the priest shall look on the plague: and, behold, if the scall spread not, and there be in it no yellow hair, and the scall be not in sight deeper than the skin;* on the seventh day the priest shall examine the itch, and if the itch has not spread, and there is no yellow hair in it, and the itch appears to be no deeper than the skin,
- 33 *He shall be shaven, but the scall shall he not shave; and the priest shall shut up him that hath the scall seven days more:* then he shall shave himself, but the itching area he shall not shave. And the priest shall shut up the person with the itch for another seven days.
- 34 *And in the seventh day the priest shall look on the scall: and, behold, if the scall be not spread in the skin, nor be in sight deeper than the skin; then the priest shall pronounce him clean: and he shall wash his clothes, and be clean.* on the seventh day the priest shall examine the itch, and if the itch has not spread in the skin and appears to be no deeper than the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. And he shall wash his clothes and be clean.
- 35 *But if the scall spread much in the skin after his cleansing;* But if the itch spreads in the skin after his cleansing,
- 36 *Then the priest shall look on him: and, behold, if the scall be spread in the skin, the priest shall not seek for yellow hair; he is unclean.* the priest shall examine him, and if the itch has spread in the skin, the priest need not seek for the yellow hair; he is unclean.
- 37 *But if the scall be in his sight at a stay, and that there is black hair grown up therein; the scall is healed, he is clean: and the priest shall pronounce him clean.* But if in his eyes the itch is unchanged and black hair has grown in it, the itch is healed. He is clean, and the priest shall pronounce him clean.
- 38 *If a man also or a woman have in the skin of their flesh bright spots, even white bright spots;* When a man or a woman has spots on the skin of the body, white spots,
- 39 *Then the priest shall look: and, behold, if the bright spots in the skin of their flesh be darkish white; it is a freckled spot that groweth in the skin; he is clean.* the priest shall look, and if the spots on the skin of the body are of a dull white, it is leukoderma that has broken out in the skin; he is clean.

- 40 *And the man whose hair is fallen off his head, he is bald; yet is he clean.* If a man's hair falls out from his head, he is bald; he is clean.
- 41 *And he that hath his hair fallen off from the part of his head toward his face, he is forehead bald: yet is he clean.* if a man's hair falls out from his forehead, he has baldness of the forehead; he is clean.
- 42 *And if there be in the bald head, or bald forehead, a white reddish sore; it is a leprosy sprung up in his bald head or his bald forehead.* But if there is on the bald head or the bald forehead a reddish-white diseased area, it is a leprous disease breaking out on his bald head or his bald forehead.
- 43 *Then the priest shall look upon it: and, behold, if the rising of the sore be white reddish in his bald head, or in his bald forehead, as the leprosy appeareth in the skin of the flesh;* Then the priest shall examine him, and if the diseased swelling is reddish-white on his bald head or his bald forehead, like the appearance of leprous disease in the skin of the body,
- 44 *He is a leprous man, he is unclean: the priest shall pronounce him utterly unclean; his plague is in his head.* he is a leprous man, he is unclean. The priest must pronounce him unclean; his disease is on his head.
- 45 *And the leper in whom the plague is, his clothes shall be rent, and his head bare, and he shall put a covering upon his upper lip, and shall cry, Unclean, unclean.* The leprous person who has the disease shall wear torn clothes and let the hair of his head hang loose. He shall cover his upper lip and cry out, Unclean, unclean.
- 46 *All the days wherein the plague shall be in him he shall be defiled; he is unclean: he shall dwell alone; without the camp shall his habitation be.* He shall remain unclean as long as he has the disease. He is unclean. He shall live alone. His dwelling shall be outside the camp.
- 47 *The garment also that the plague of leprosy is in, whether it be a woollen garment, or a linen garment;* When there is a case of leprous disease in a garment, whether a woolen or a linen garment,
- 48 *Whether it be in the warp, or woof; of linen, or of woollen; whether in a skin, or in any thing made of skin;* in warp or woof of linen or wool, or in a skin or in anything made of skin,

- 49 *And if the plague be greenish or reddish in the garment, or in the skin, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin; it is a plague of leprosy, and shall be shewed unto the priest:* if the disease is greenish or reddish in the garment, or in the skin or in the warp or the woof or in any article made of skin, it is a case of leprous disease. It shall be shown to the priest.
- 50 *And the priest shall look upon the plague, and shut up it that hath the plague seven days:* the priest shall examine the disease and shut up the diseased thing for seven days.
- 51 *And he shall look on the plague on the seventh day: if the plague be spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in a skin, or in any work that is made of skin; the plague is a fretting leprosy; it is unclean.* Then he shall examine the disease on the seventh day. If the disease has spread in the garment, in the warp or the woof, or in the skin, whatever be the use of the skin, the disease is a persistent leprous disease; it is unclean.
- 52 *He shall therefore burn that garment, whether warp or woof, in woollen or in linen, or any thing of skin, wherein the plague is: for it is a fretting leprosy; it shall be burnt in the fire.* he shall burn the garment, or the warp or the woof, the wool or the linen, or any article made of skin that is diseased, for it is a persistent leprous disease. It shall be burned in fire.
- 53 *And if the priest shall look, and, behold, the plague be not spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin;* if the priest examines, and if the disease has not spread in the garment, in warp or woof or in any article made of skin,
- 54 *Then the priest shall command that they wash the thing wherein the plague is, and he shall shut it up seven days more:* then the priest shall command that they wash the thing in which is the disease. He shall shut it up for another seven days.
- 55 *And the priest shall look on the plague, after that it is washed: and, behold, if the plague have not changed his colour, and the plague be not spread; it is unclean; thou shalt burn it in the fire; it is fret inward, whether it be bare within or without.* Then the priest shall examine the diseased thing after it has been washed. And if the diseased area has not changed color, though the disease has not spread, it is unclean. You shall burn it in fire, whether the rot is on the back or on the front.

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| <p>56 <i>And if the priest look, and, behold, the plague be somewhat dark after the washing of it; then he shall rend it out of the garment, or out of the skin, or out of the warp, or out of the woof:</i></p> <p>57 <i>And if it appear still in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin; it is a spreading plague: thou shalt burn that wherein the plague is with fire.</i></p> <p>58 <i>And the garment, either warp, or woof, or whatsoever thing of skin it be, which thou shalt wash, if the plague be departed from them, then it shall be washed the second time, and shall be clean.</i></p> <p>59 <i>This is the law of the plague of leprosy in a garment of woollen or linen, either in the warp, or woof, or any thing of skins, to pronounce it clean, or to pronounce it unclean.</i></p> | <p>But if the priest examines, and if the diseased area has faded after it is washed, then he shall tear it out of the garment or the skin or the warp or the woof.</p> <p>if it appears again in the garment, in warp or woof, or in any article made of skin, it is spreading. You shall burn with fire whatever has the disease.</p> <p>But the garment, or warp or woof, or any article made of skin from which the disease departs when you have washed it, shall then be washed a second time, and be clean.</p> <p>This is the law for a case of leprous disease in a garment of wool or linen, either in warp or woof, or in any article made of skin, for pronouncing it clean or unclean.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v2 — Deut 24:8

v6 — Lev 11:25

v45 — Lev 10:6; Mic 3:7; Ezek 24:17; Lam 4:15; Ezek 24:22

v46 — 2 Kgs 7:3; 2 Kgs 15:5

Chapter 14

The LORD gives laws for the cleansing ritual of a healed leper, involving two birds, cedarwood, scarlet yarn, and hyssop. He also gives instructions for diagnosing and cleansing leprous disease in houses, including scraping, replastering, or demolishing the affected structure.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 <i>This shall be the law of the leper in the day of his cleansing: He shall be brought unto the priest:</i> | "This shall be the law of the leprous person for the day of his cleansing. He shall be brought to the priest, |
| 3 <i>And the priest shall go forth out of the camp; and the priest shall look, and, behold, if the plague of leprosy be healed in the leper;</i> | the priest shall go out of the camp, and the priest shall look. Then, if the case of leprous disease is healed in the leprous person, |
| 4 <i>Then shall the priest command to take for him that is to be cleansed two birds alive and clean, and cedar wood, and scarlet, and hyssop:</i> | the priest shall command them to take for him who is to be cleansed two live clean birds and cedarwood and scarlet yarn and hyssop. |
| 5 <i>And the priest shall command that one of the birds be killed in an earthen vessel over running water:</i> | the priest shall command them to kill one of the birds in an earthenware vessel over fresh water. |
| 6 <i>As for the living bird, he shall take it, and the cedar wood, and the scarlet, and the hyssop, and shall dip them and the living bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the running water:</i> | He shall take the live bird with the cedarwood and the scarlet yarn and the hyssop, and dip them and the live bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the fresh water. |
| 7 <i>And he shall sprinkle upon him that is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird loose into the open field.</i> | he shall sprinkle it seven times on him who is to be cleansed of the leprous disease. Then he shall pronounce him clean and shall let the living bird go into the open field. |
| 8 <i>And he that is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes, and shave off all his hair, and wash himself in water, that he may be clean: and after that he shall come into the camp, and shall tarry abroad out of his tent seven days.</i> | he who is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes and shave off all his hair and bathe himself in water. He shall be clean. And after that he may come into the camp, but shall live outside his tent seven days. |

- 9 *But it shall be on the seventh day, that he shall shave all his hair off his head and his beard and his eyebrows, even all his hair he shall shave off: and he shall wash his clothes, also he shall wash his flesh in water, and he shall be clean.* on the seventh day he shall shave off all his hair from his head, his beard, and his eyebrows. He shall shave off all his hair, and then he shall wash his clothes and bathe his body in water. He shall be clean.
- 10 *And on the eighth day he shall take two he lambs without blemish, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish, and three tenth deals of fine flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, and one log of oil.* on the eighth day he shall take two male lambs without blemish, and one ewe lamb a year old without blemish, and a grain offering of three tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil, and one log of oil.
- 11 *And the priest that maketh him clean shall present the man that is to be made clean, and those things, before the LORD, at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:* the priest who cleanses him shall set the man who is to be cleansed and these things before the LORD, at the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 12 *And the priest shall take one he lamb, and offer him for a trespass offering, and the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:* the priest shall take one of the male lambs and offer it for a guilt offering, along with the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.
- 13 *And he shall slay the lamb in the place where he shall kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, in the holy place: for as the sin offering is the priest's, so is the trespass offering: it is most holy:* he shall kill the lamb in the place where they kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, in the place of the sanctuary. For the guilt offering, like the sin offering, belongs to the priest; it is most holy.

- 14 *And the priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and the priest shall put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot:* The priest shall take some of the blood of the guilt offering, and the priest shall put it on the lobe of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot.
- 15 *And the priest shall take some of the log of oil, and pour it into the palm of his own left hand:* Then the priest shall take some of the log of oil and pour it into the palm of his own left hand
- 16 *And the priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD:* dip His right finger in the oil that is in His left hand and sprinkle some oil with His finger seven times before the LORD.
- 17 *And of the rest of the oil that is in his hand shall the priest put upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot, upon the blood of the trespass offering:* some of the oil that remains in his hand the priest shall put on the lobe of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot, on top of the blood of the guilt offering.
- 18 *And the remnant of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall pour upon the head of him that is to be cleansed: and the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD.* the rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed. Then the priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD.
- 19 *And the priest shall offer the sin offering, and make an atonement for him that is to be cleansed from his uncleanness; and afterward he shall kill the burnt offering:* The priest shall offer the sin offering, to make atonement for him who is to be cleansed from his uncleanness. And afterward he shall kill the burnt offering.

- 20 *And the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the meat offering upon the altar: and the priest shall make an atonement for him, and he shall be clean.* the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the grain offering on the altar. Thus the priest shall make atonement for him. He shall be clean.
- 21 *And if he be poor, and cannot get so much; then he shall take one lamb for a trespass offering to be waved, to make an atonement for him, and one tenth deal of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering, and a log of oil;* But if he is poor and cannot afford so much, then he shall take one male lamb for a guilt offering to be waved, to make atonement for him, and a tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering, and a log of oil;
- 22 *And two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, such as he is able to get; and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering.* two turtledoves or two pigeons, whichever he can afford. The one shall be a sin offering and the other a burnt offering.
- 23 *And he shall bring them on the eighth day for his cleansing unto the priest, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, before the LORD.* on the eighth day He shall bring them for His cleansing to the priest, to the entrance of the tent of meeting, before the LORD.
- 24 *And the priest shall take the lamb of the trespass offering, and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:* the priest shall take the lamb of the guilt offering and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.
- 25 *And he shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering, and the priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot:* he shall kill the lamb of the guilt offering. And the priest shall take some of the blood of the guilt offering and put it on the lobe of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot.
- 26 *And the priest shall pour of the oil into the palm of his own left hand:* the priest shall pour some of the oil into the palm of his own left hand,

- 27 *And the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his left hand seven times before the LORD:* the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in His left hand seven times before the LORD.
- 28 *And the priest shall put of the oil that is in his hand upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot, upon the place of the blood of the trespass offering:* the priest shall put some of the oil that is in his hand on the lobe of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot, in the place where the blood of the guilt offering was put.
- 29 *And the rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put upon the head of him that is to be cleansed, to make an atonement for him before the LORD.* the rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, to make atonement for Him before the LORD.
- 30 *And he shall offer the one of the turtledoves, or of the young pigeons, such as he can get;* he shall offer, of the turtledoves or pigeons, whichever He can afford,
- 31 *Even such as he is able to get, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, with the meat offering: and the priest shall make an atonement for him that is to be cleansed before the LORD.* one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering, along with a grain offering. And the priest shall make atonement before the LORD for Him who is being cleansed.
- 32 *This is the law of him in whom is the plague of leprosy, whose hand is not able to get that which pertaineth to his cleansing.* This is the law for Him in whom is a case of leprous disease, who cannot afford the offerings for His cleansing.'
- 33 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying,

- 34 *When ye be come into the land of Canaan, which I give to you for a possession, and I put the plague of leprosy in a house of the land of your possession;* 'When You come into the land of Canaan, which I give You for a possession, and I put a case of leprous disease in a house in the land of Your possession,
- 35 *And he that owneth the house shall come and tell the priest, saying, It seemeth to me there is as it were a plague in the house:* then he who owns the house shall come and tell the priest, It seems to me there is some kind of disease in my house.
- 36 *Then the priest shall command that they empty the house, before the priest go into it to see the plague, that all that is in the house be not made unclean: and afterward the priest shall go in to see the house:* Then the priest shall command that they empty the house before the priest goes in to examine the disease, lest all that is in the house be declared unclean. And afterward the priest shall go in to examine the house.
- 37 *And he shall look on the plague, and, behold, if the plague be in the walls of the house with hollow strakes, greenish or reddish, which in sight are lower than the wall;* he shall examine the disease. And if the disease is in the walls of the house with greenish or reddish spots, and if it appears to be deeper than the surface,
- 38 *Then the priest shall go out of the house to the door of the house, and shut up the house seven days:* then the priest shall go out of the house to the door of the house and shut up the house for seven days.
- 39 *And the priest shall come again the seventh day, and shall look: and, behold, if the plague be spread in the walls of the house;* the priest shall come again on the seventh day, and look. If the disease has spread in the walls of the house,
- 40 *Then the priest shall command that they take away the stones in which the plague is, and they shall cast them into an unclean place without the city:* then the priest shall command that they take out the stones in which is the disease and throw them into an unclean place outside the city.

- 41 *And he shall cause the house to be scraped within round about, and they shall pour out the dust that they scrape off without the city into an unclean place:* he shall have the inside of the house scraped all around, and the plaster that they scrape off they shall pour into an unclean place outside the city.
- 42 *And they shall take other stones, and put them in the place of those stones; and he shall take other mortar, and shall plaister the house.* Then they shall take other stones and put them in the place of those stones. He shall take other plaster and plaster the house.
- 43 *And if the plague come again, and break out in the house, after that he hath taken away the stones, and after he hath scraped the house, and after it is plaistered;* If the disease breaks out again in the house, after he has taken out the stones and scraped the house and plastered it,
- 44 *Then the priest shall come and look, and, behold, if the plague be spread in the house, it is a fretting leprosy in the house: it is unclean.* then the priest shall go and look. And if the disease has spread in the house, it is a persistent leprous disease in the house; it is unclean.
- 45 *And he shall break down the house, the stones of it, and the timber thereof, and all the mortar of the house; and he shall carry them forth out of the city into an unclean place.* he shall break down the house, its stones and timber and all the plaster of the house. He shall carry them out of the city to an unclean place.
- 46 *Moreover he that goeth into the house all the while that it is shut up shall be unclean until the even.* Moreover, whoever enters the house while it is shut up shall be unclean until the evening.
- 47 *And he that lieth in the house shall wash his clothes; and he that eateth in the house shall wash his clothes.* whoever sleeps in the house shall wash his clothes, and whoever eats in the house shall wash his clothes.
- 48 *And if the priest shall come in, and look upon it, and, behold, the plague hath not spread in the house, after the house was plaistered: then the priest shall pronounce the house clean, because the plague is healed.* But if the priest comes and looks, and if the disease has not spread in the house after the house was plastered, then the priest shall pronounce the house clean, for the disease is healed.

- 49 *And he shall take to cleanse the house two birds, and cedar wood, and scarlet, and hyssop:* for the cleansing of the house he shall take two small birds, with cedarwood and scarlet yarn and hyssop,
- 50 *And he shall kill the one of the birds in an earthen vessel over running water:* he shall kill one of the birds in an earthenware vessel over fresh water
- 51 *And he shall take the cedar wood, and the hyssop, and the scarlet, and the living bird, and dip them in the blood of the slain bird, and in the running water, and sprinkle the house seven times:* shall take the cedarwood and the hyssop and the scarlet yarn and the live bird, and dip them in the blood of the slain bird and in the fresh water, and sprinkle the house seven times.
- 52 *And he shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird, and with the running water, and with the living bird, and with the cedar wood, and with the hyssop, and with the scarlet:* Thus he shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird and with the fresh water and with the live bird and with the cedarwood and hyssop and scarlet yarn.
- 53 *But he shall let go the living bird out of the city into the open fields, and make an atonement for the house: and it shall be clean.* he shall let the live bird go out of the city into the open country. So he shall make atonement for the house. It shall be clean.
- 54 *This is the law for all manner of plague of leprosy, and scall,* This is the law for any case of leprous disease: for an itch,
- 55 *And for the leprosy of a garment, and of a house,* for leprous disease in a garment or in a house,
- 56 *And for a rising, and for a scab, and for a bright spot:* for a swelling or an eruption or a spot,
- 57 *To teach when it is unclean, and when it is clean: this is the law of leprosy.* to show when it is unclean and when it is clean. This is the law for leprous disease.'

Words in this chapter:

Canaan (KAY-nan) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Luke 17:14; Luke 5:12-14
 v4 — Num 19:6
 v8 — Lev 11:25
 v10 — Lev 2:1
 v12 — Ex 29:24
 v14 — Ex 29:20; Lev 8:23-24
 v18 — Lev 4:26
 v21 — Lev 5:7
 v35 — Ps 91:10
 v56 — Lev 13:2
 v57 — Lev 10:10

Chapter 15

The LORD gives laws concerning bodily discharges that cause ceremonial uncleanness. Men with abnormal discharges and women during menstruation or with prolonged bleeding are unclean, and after their discharge ends they must wait seven days and bring offerings to the priest for atonement.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and to Aaron, saying,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When any man hath a running issue out of his flesh, because of his issue he is unclean.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And this shall be his uncleanness in his issue: whether his flesh run with his issue, or his flesh be stopped from his issue, it is his uncleanness.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Every bed, whereon he lieth that hath the issue, is unclean: and every thing, whereon he sitteth, shall be unclean.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And whosoever toucheth his bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.</i></p> | <p>The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying,</p> <p>'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, When any man has a discharge from His body, His discharge is unclean.</p> <p>this is the law of His uncleanness for a discharge: whether His body runs with His discharge, or His body is blocked up by His discharge, it is His uncleanness.</p> <p>Every bed on which the one with the discharge lies shall be unclean, and everything on which He sits shall be unclean.</p> <p>anyone who touches his bed shall wash his clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.</p> |
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- 6 *And he that sitteth on any thing whereon he sat that hath the issue shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever sits on anything on which the one with the discharge has sat shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 7 *And he that toucheth the flesh of him that hath the issue shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever touches the body of the one with the discharge shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 8 *And if he that hath the issue spit upon him that is clean; then he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* if the one with the discharge spits on someone who is clean, then he shall wash his clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 9 *And what saddle soever he rideth upon that hath the issue shall be unclean.* any saddle on which the one with the discharge rides shall be unclean.
- 10 *And whosoever toucheth any thing that was under him shall be unclean until the even: and he that beareth any of those things shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever touches anything that was under him shall be unclean until the evening. And whoever carries such things shall wash his clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 11 *And whomsoever he toucheth that hath the issue, and hath not rinsed his hands in water, he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* Anyone whom the one with the discharge touches without having rinsed His hands in water shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 12 *And the vessel of earth, that he toucheth which hath the issue, shall be broken: and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed in water.* an earthenware vessel that the one with the discharge touches shall be broken, and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed in water.

- 13 *And when he that hath an issue is cleansed of his issue; then he shall number to himself seven days for his cleansing, and wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in running water, and shall be clean.* when the one with a discharge is cleansed of His discharge, then He shall count for Himself seven days for His cleansing, and wash His clothes. And He shall bathe His body in fresh water and shall be clean.
- 14 *And on the eighth day he shall take to him two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and come before the LORD unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and give them unto the priest:* on the eighth day He shall take to Himself two turtledoves or two pigeons and come before the LORD to the entrance of the tent of meeting and give them to the priest.
- 15 *And the priest shall offer them, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD for his issue.* the priest shall use them, one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering. And the priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD for His discharge.
- 16 *And if any man's seed of copulation go out from him, then he shall wash all his flesh in water, and be unclean until the even.* If a man has an emission of semen, he shall bathe his whole body in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 17 *And every garment, and every skin, whereon is the seed of copulation, shall be washed with water, and be unclean until the even.* every garment and every skin on which the semen comes shall be washed with water and be unclean until the evening.
- 18 *The woman also with whom man shall lie with seed of copulation, they shall both bathe themselves in water, and be unclean until the even.* If a man lies with a woman and has an emission of semen, both of them shall bathe themselves in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 19 *And if a woman have an issue, and her issue in her flesh be blood, she shall be put apart seven days: and whosoever toucheth her shall be unclean until the even.* When a woman has a discharge, and the discharge in her body is blood, she shall be in her menstrual impurity for seven days, and whoever touches her shall be unclean until the evening.

- 20 *And every thing that she lieth upon in her separation shall be unclean: every thing also that she sitteth upon shall be unclean.* everything on which she lies during her menstrual impurity shall be unclean. Everything also on which she sits shall be unclean.
- 21 *And whosoever toucheth her bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever touches her bed shall wash his clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 22 *And whosoever toucheth any thing that she sat upon shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever touches anything on which she sits shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 23 *And if it be on her bed, or on any thing whereon she sitteth, when he toucheth it, he shall be unclean until the even.* Whether it is the bed or anything on which she sits, when He touches it He shall be unclean until the evening.
- 24 *And if any man lie with her at all, and her flowers be upon him, he shall be unclean seven days; and all the bed whereon he lieth shall be unclean.* if any man lies with her and her menstrual impurity comes upon Him, He shall be unclean seven days, and every bed on which He lies shall be unclean.
- 25 *And if a woman have an issue of her blood many days out of the time of her separation, or if it run beyond the time of her separation; all the days of the issue of her uncleanness shall be as the days of her separation: she shall be unclean.* If a woman has a discharge of blood for many days, not at the time of her menstrual impurity, or if she has a discharge beyond the time of her impurity, all the days of the discharge she shall continue in uncleanness. As in the days of her menstrual impurity, she shall be unclean.
- 26 *Every bed whereon she lieth all the days of her issue shall be unto her as the bed of her separation: and whatsoever she sitteth upon shall be unclean, as the uncleanness of her separation.* Every bed on which she lies during all the days of her discharge shall be treated as the bed of her menstrual impurity. And everything on which she sits shall be unclean, as in the uncleanness of her menstrual impurity.

- 27 *And whosoever toucheth those things shall be unclean, and shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.* whoever touches these things shall be unclean, and shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening.
- 28 *But if she be cleansed of her issue, then she shall number to herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean.* But if she is cleansed of her discharge, she shall count for herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean.
- 29 *And on the eighth day she shall take unto her two turtles, or two young pigeons, and bring them unto the priest, to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* on the eighth day she shall take to herself two turtledoves or two pigeons and bring them to the priest, to the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 30 *And the priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for her before the LORD for the issue of her uncleanness.* the priest shall offer one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering. And the priest shall make atonement for her before the LORD for her unclean discharge.
- 31 *Thus shall ye separate the children of Israel from their uncleanness; that they die not in their uncleanness, when they defile my tabernacle that is among them.* Thus You shall keep the children of Israel separate from their uncleanness, lest they die in their uncleanness by defiling my tabernacle that is in their midst.'
- 32 *This is the law of him that hath an issue, and of him whose seed goeth from him, and is defiled therewith;* This is the law for Him who has a discharge and for Him who has an emission of semen, becoming unclean thereby;
- 33 *And of her that is sick of her flowers, and of him that hath an issue, of the man, and of the woman, and of him that lieth with her that is unclean.* also for her who is unwell with her menstrual impurity, that is, for anyone, male or female, who has a discharge, and for the man who lies with a woman who is unclean.

Words in this chapter:

atonement — The payment for sin that brings God and man back together — covering sin so the relationship is restored.

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v2 — Num 5:2; Lev 22:4; 2 Sam 3:29

v12 — Lev 6:28

v16 — Deut 23:10-11; Lev 22:4

v19 — Lev 12:2

v24 — Lev 20:18

v25 — Matt 9:20; Luke 8:43; Mark 5:25

v31 — Num 19:20; Num 19:13; Ezek 5:11; Num 5:3; Ezek 23:38

Chapter 16

The LORD gives instructions for the Day of Atonement, the one day each year when the high priest enters the Most Holy Place. Aaron casts lots over two goats -- one is sacrificed as a sin offering and its blood sprinkled on the mercy seat, while the other is sent into the wilderness as the scapegoat bearing the people's sins.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses after the death of the two sons of Aaron, when they offered before the LORD, and died;* The LORD spoke to Moses after the death of the two sons of Aaron, when they drew near before the LORD and died,
- 2 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Speak unto Aaron thy brother, that he come not at all times into the holy place within the vail before the mercy seat, which is upon the ark; that he die not: for I will appear in the cloud upon the mercy seat.* the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron your brother not to come at any time into the Holy Place inside the veil, before the mercy seat that is on the ark, so that he may not die. For I will appear in the cloud over the mercy seat.
- 3 *Thus shall Aaron come into the holy place: with a young bullock for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering.* But in this way Aaron shall come into the Holy Place: with a bull from the herd for a sin offering and a ram for a burnt offering.

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| <p>4 <i>He shall put on the holy linen coat, and he shall have the linen breeches upon his flesh, and shall be girded with a linen girdle, and with the linen mitre shall he be attired: these are holy garments; therefore shall he wash his flesh in water, and so put them on.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And he shall take of the congregation of the children of Israel two kids of the goats for a sin offering, and one ram for a burnt offering.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And Aaron shall offer his bullock of the sin offering, which is for himself, and make an atonement for himself, and for his house.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And he shall take the two goats, and present them before the LORD at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.</i></p> | <p>He shall put on the holy linen coat and shall have the linen undergarment on his body, fasten the linen sash around his waist, and wear the linen turban; these are the holy garments. He shall bathe his body in water and then put them on.</p> <p>he shall take from the congregation of the children of Israel two male goats for a sin offering, and one ram for a burnt offering.</p> <p>Aaron shall offer the bull as a sin offering for himself and shall make atonement for himself and for his house.</p> <p>Then He shall take the two goats and set them before the LORD at the entrance of the tent of meeting.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Azazel (uh-ZAY-zel) — "Removal, entire removal; or possibly a desert demon/place name" The destination of the second goat on the Day of Atonement — sent into the wilderness bearing the sins of Israel confessed over its head. Rendered 'scapegoat' in the KJV. The goat for the LORD was sacrificed; the goat for Azazel carried the sin away.

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| <p>8 <i>And Aaron shall cast lots upon the two goats; one lot for the LORD, and the other lot for the scapegoat.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Aaron shall bring the goat upon which the LORD's lot fell, and offer him for a sin offering.</i></p> <p>10 <i>But the goat, on which the lot fell to be the scapegoat, shall be presented alive before the LORD, to make an atonement with him, and to let him go for a scapegoat into the wilderness.</i></p> | <p>Aaron shall cast lots over the two goats, one lot for the LORD and the other lot for the scapegoat.</p> <p>Aaron shall present the goat on which the lot fell for the LORD and use it as a sin offering,</p> <p>but the goat on which the lot fell for the scapegoat shall be presented alive before the LORD to make atonement over it, that it may be sent as the scapegoat into the wilderness.</p> |
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- 11 *And Aaron shall bring the bullock of the sin offering, which is for himself, and shall make an atonement for himself, and for his house, and shall kill the bullock of the sin offering which is for himself:* Aaron shall present the bull as a sin offering for himself, and shall make atonement for himself and for his house. He shall kill the bull as a sin offering for himself.
- 12 *And he shall take a censer full of burning coals of fire from off the altar before the LORD, and his hands full of sweet incense beaten small, and bring it within the veil:* he shall take a censer full of coals of fire from the altar before the LORD, and two handfuls of sweet incense beaten fine. He shall bring it inside the veil
- 13 *And he shall put the incense upon the fire before the LORD, that the cloud of the incense may cover the mercy seat that is upon the testimony, that he die not:* put the incense on the fire before the LORD, that the cloud of the incense may cover the mercy seat that is over the testimony, so that He does not die.
- 14 *And he shall take of the blood of the bullock, and sprinkle it with his finger upon the mercy seat eastward; and before the mercy seat shall he sprinkle of the blood with his finger seven times.* he shall take some of the blood of the bull and sprinkle it with His finger on the front of the mercy seat on the east side, and in front of the mercy seat He shall sprinkle some of the blood with His finger seven times.
- 15 *Then shall he kill the goat of the sin offering, that is for the people, and bring his blood within the veil, and do with that blood as he did with the blood of the bullock, and sprinkle it upon the mercy seat, and before the mercy seat:* Then He shall kill the goat of the sin offering that is for the people and bring its blood inside the veil and do with its blood as He did with the blood of the bull, sprinkling it over the mercy seat and in front of the mercy seat.

- 16 *And he shall make an atonement for the holy place, because of the uncleanness of the children of Israel, and because of their transgressions in all their sins: and so shall he do for the tabernacle of the congregation, that remaineth among them in the midst of their uncleanness.* Thus He shall make atonement for the Holy Place, because of the uncleannesses of the children of Israel and because of their transgressions, all their sins. And so He shall do for the tent of meeting, which dwells with them in the midst of their uncleannesses.
- 17 *And there shall be no man in the tabernacle of the congregation when he goeth in to make an atonement in the holy place, until he come out, and have made an atonement for himself, and for his household, and for all the congregation of Israel.* No one may be in the tent of meeting from the time He enters to make atonement in the Holy Place until He comes out and has made atonement for Himself and for His house and for all the assembly of Israel.
- 18 *And he shall go out unto the altar that is before the LORD, and make an atonement for it; and shall take of the blood of the bullock, and of the blood of the goat, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about.* Then He shall go out to the altar that is before the LORD and make atonement for it, and shall take some of the blood of the bull and some of the blood of the goat, and put it on the horns of the altar all around.
- 19 *And he shall sprinkle of the blood upon it with his finger seven times, and cleanse it, and hallow it from the uncleanness of the children of Israel.* he shall sprinkle some of the blood on it with His finger seven times, and cleanse it and consecrate it from the uncleannesses of the children of Israel.
- 20 *And when he hath made an end of reconciling the holy place, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and the altar, he shall bring the live goat:* when He has made an end of atoning for the Holy Place and the tent of meeting and the altar, He shall present the live goat.

- 21 *And Aaron shall lay both his hands upon the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions in all their sins, putting them upon the head of the goat, and shall send him away by the hand of a fit man into the wilderness:* Aaron shall lay both his hands on the head of the live goat, and confess over it all the iniquities of the children of Israel. All their transgressions, all their sins. And he shall put them on the head of the goat and send it away into the wilderness by the hand of a man who is in readiness.
- 22 *And the goat shall bear upon him all their iniquities unto a land not inhabited: and he shall let go the goat in the wilderness.* The goat shall bear all their iniquities on itself to a remote area. He shall let the goat go free in the wilderness.
- 23 *And Aaron shall come into the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall put off the linen garments, which he put on when he went into the holy place, and shall leave them there:* Then Aaron shall come into the tent of meeting and shall take off the linen garments that he put on when he went into the Holy Place and shall leave them there.
- 24 *And he shall wash his flesh with water in the holy place, and put on his garments, and come forth, and offer his burnt offering, and the burnt offering of the people, and make an atonement for himself, and for the people.* he shall bathe his body in water in a holy place and put on his garments and come out and offer his burnt offering and the burnt offering of the people and make atonement for himself and for the people.
- 25 *And the fat of the sin offering shall he burn upon the altar.* the fat of the sin offering he shall burn on the altar.
- 26 *And he that let go the goat for the scapegoat shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward come into the camp.* he who lets the goat go to the scapegoat shall wash his clothes and bathe his body in water, and afterward he may come into the camp.

- 27 *And the bullock for the sin offering, and the goat for the sin offering, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the holy place, shall one carry forth without the camp; and they shall burn in the fire their skins, and their flesh, and their dung.* the bull for the sin offering and the goat for the sin offering, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the Holy Place, shall be carried outside the camp. Their skin and their flesh and their dung shall be burned up with fire.
- 28 *And he that burneth them shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp.* he who burns them shall wash his clothes and bathe his body in water, and afterward he may come into the camp.
- 29 *And this shall be a statute for ever unto you: that in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, ye shall afflict your souls, and do no work at all, whether it be one of your own country, or a stranger that sojourneth among you:* it shall be a statute to you forever that in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, you shall afflict yourselves and shall do no work, either the native or the stranger who sojourns among you.
- 30 *For on that day shall the priest make an atonement for you, to cleanse you, that ye may be clean from all your sins before the LORD.* For on this day shall atonement be made for You to cleanse You. You shall be clean before the LORD from all Your sins.
- 31 *It shall be a sabbath of rest unto you, and ye shall afflict your souls, by a statute for ever.* It is a Sabbath of solemn rest to You, and You shall afflict yourselves; it is a statute forever.
- 32 *And the priest, whom he shall anoint, and whom he shall consecrate to minister in the priest's office in his father's stead, shall make the atonement, and shall put on the linen clothes, even the holy garments:* the priest who is anointed and consecrated as priest in his father's place shall make atonement, wearing the holy linen garments.

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| <p>33 <i>And he shall make an atonement for the holy sanctuary, and he shall make an atonement for the tabernacle of the congregation, and for the altar, and he shall make an atonement for the priests, and for all the people of the congregation.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And this shall be an everlasting statute unto you, to make an atonement for the children of Israel for all their sins once a year. And he did as the LORD commanded Moses.</i></p> | <p>He shall make atonement for the holy sanctuary. He shall make atonement for the tent of meeting and for the altar. He shall make atonement for the priests and for all the people of the assembly.</p> <p>this shall be a statute forever for You, that atonement may be made for the children of Israel once in the year because of all their sins.' And Aaron did as the LORD commanded Moses.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

mercy seat — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.

scapegoat — The goat that carried sin away on the Day of Atonement — it pictures how Christ bears our sin and removes it.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 10:1-2
- v2 — Ex 30:10; 1 Kgs 8:10-12; Heb 10:19-20; Heb 9:25; Heb 9:7-8
- v4 — Ex 28:39-43; Ex 30:20; Ezek 44:17-18; Heb 7:26
- v6 — Lev 9:7
- v10 — 1 John 2:2
- v12 — Ex 30:34-38; Lev 10:1; Rev 8:3-4; Num 16:46
- v14 — Lev 4:5-6; Heb 9:25
- v15 — Heb 9:7
- v21 — 2 Cor 5:21; Isa 53:6
- v27 — Lev 6:30; Lev 4:21
- v29 — Isa 58:3; Num 29:7
- v34 — Heb 9:7; Heb 9:25; Ex 30:10

Chapter 17

The LORD commands that all sacrifices must be brought to the entrance of the tent of meeting and not offered in the open field. He strictly forbids the eating of blood, declaring that the life of the flesh is in the blood and He has given it on the altar to make atonement.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto Aaron, and unto his sons, and unto all the children of Israel, and say unto them; This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded, saying,</i> | 'Speak to Aaron and his sons and to all the children of Israel and say to them, This is the thing that the LORD has commanded. |
| 3 | <i>What man soever there be of the house of Israel, that killeth an ox, or lamb, or goat, in the camp, or that killeth it out of the camp,</i> | If any one of the house of Israel kills an ox or a lamb or a goat in the camp, or kills it outside the camp, |
| 4 | <i>And bringeth it not unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, to offer an offering unto the LORD before the tabernacle of the LORD; blood shall be imputed unto that man; he hath shed blood; and that man shall be cut off from among his people:</i> | does not bring it to the entrance of the tent of meeting to offer it as an offering to the LORD in front of the tabernacle of the LORD, bloodguilt shall be imputed to that man. He has shed blood, and that man shall be cut off from among his people. |
| 5 | <i>To the end that the children of Israel may bring their sacrifices, which they offer in the open field, even that they may bring them unto the LORD, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, unto the priest, and offer them for peace offerings unto the LORD.</i> | This is to the end that the children of Israel may bring their sacrifices that they sacrifice in the open field, that they may bring them to the LORD, to the priest at the entrance of the tent of meeting, and sacrifice them as peace offerings to the LORD. |
| 6 | <i>And the priest shall sprinkle the blood upon the altar of the LORD at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and burn the fat for a sweet savour unto the LORD.</i> | the priest shall throw the blood on the altar of the LORD at the entrance of the tent of meeting and burn the fat for a sweet savour unto the LORD. |

- 7 *And they shall no more offer their sacrifices unto devils, after whom they have gone a whoring. This shall be a statute for ever unto them throughout their generations.* So they shall no more sacrifice their sacrifices to goat demons, after whom they whore. This shall be a statute forever for them throughout their generations.
- 8 *And thou shalt say unto them, Whatsoever man there be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers which sojourn among you, that offereth a burnt offering or sacrifice,* you shall say to them, Any one of the house of Israel, or of the strangers who stay among them, who offers a burnt offering or sacrifice
- 9 *And bringeth it not unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, to offer it unto the LORD; even that man shall be cut off from among his people.* does not bring it to the entrance of the tent of meeting to offer it to the LORD, that man shall be cut off from his people.
- 10 *And whatsoever man there be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn among you, that eateth any manner of blood; I will even set my face against that soul that eateth blood, and will cut him off from among his people.* If any one of the house of Israel or of the strangers who stay among them eats any blood, I will set my face against that person who eats blood and will cut Him off from among His people.
- 11 *For the life of the flesh is in the blood: and I have given it to you upon the altar to make an atonement for your souls: for it is the blood that maketh an atonement for the soul.* For the life of the flesh is in the blood. I have given it for You on the altar to make atonement for Your souls, for it is the blood that makes atonement for the soul.
- 12 *Therefore I said unto the children of Israel, No soul of you shall eat blood, neither shall any stranger that sojourneth among you eat blood.* Therefore I have said to the children of Israel, No person among You shall eat blood, neither shall any stranger who sojourns among You eat blood.

- 13 *And whatsoever man there be of the children of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn among you, which hunteth and catcheth any beast or fowl that may be eaten; he shall even pour out the blood thereof, and cover it with dust.* Any one also of the children of Israel, or of the strangers who stay among them, who takes in hunting any beast or bird that may be eaten shall pour out its blood and cover it with earth.
- 14 *For it is the life of all flesh; the blood of it is for the life thereof: therefore I said unto the children of Israel, Ye shall eat the blood of no manner of flesh: for the life of all flesh is the blood thereof: whosoever eateth it shall be cut off.* For the life of every creature is its blood: its blood is its life. Therefore I have said to the children of Israel, You shall not eat the blood of any creature, for the life of every creature is its blood. Whoever eats it shall be cut off.
- 15 *And every soul that eateth that which died of itself, or that which was torn with beasts, whether it be one of your own country, or a stranger, he shall both wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even: then shall he be clean.* every person who eats what dies of itself or what is torn by beasts, whether He is a native or a sojourner, shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water and be unclean until the evening; then He shall be clean.
- 16 *But if he wash them not, nor bathe his flesh; then he shall bear his iniquity.* But if He does not wash them or bathe His flesh, He shall bear His iniquity.'

Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

- v7 — 1 Cor 10:20; Ex 34:15; Deut 32:17; 2 Chr 11:15
 v10 — Lev 17:11; Deut 12:23; Lev 3:17; Deut 12:16; Jer 44:11
 v11 — Heb 9:22; 1 John 1:7; Rom 3:25; Rev 1:5; Mark 14:24
 v13 — Deut 12:16
 v14 — Gen 9:4; Deut 12:23
 v15 — Deut 14:21; Lev 22:8; Ex 22:31

Chapter 18

The LORD forbids Israel from following the practices of Egypt and Canaan, then lists prohibited sexual relations including incest, adultery, homosexuality, and bestiality. He warns that the land will vomit out those who commit these abominations, as it did the nations before them.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, I am the LORD your God.</i> | 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, I am the LORD Your God. |
| 3 | <i>After the doings of the land of Egypt, wherein ye dwelt, shall ye not do: and after the doings of the land of Canaan, whither I bring you, shall ye not do: neither shall ye walk in their ordinances.</i> | You shall not do as they do in the land of Egypt, where You lived, and You shall not do as they do in the land of Canaan, to which I am bringing You. You shall not walk in their statutes. |
| 4 | <i>Ye shall do my judgments, and keep mine ordinances, to walk therein: I am the LORD your God.</i> | You shall follow my rules and keep my statutes and walk in them. I am the LORD Your God. |
| 5 | <i>Ye shall therefore keep my statutes, and my judgments: which if a man do, he shall live in them: I am the LORD.</i> | You shall therefore keep my statutes and my rules; if a person does them, He shall live by them: I am the LORD. |
| 6 | <i>None of you shall approach to any that is near of kin to him, to uncover their nakedness: I am the LORD.</i> | None of You shall approach any one of His close relatives to uncover nakedness. I am the LORD. |
| 7 | <i>The nakedness of thy father, or the nakedness of thy mother, shalt thou not uncover: she is thy mother; thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.</i> | You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your father, which is the nakedness of Your mother; she is Your mother, You shall not uncover her nakedness. |
| 8 | <i>The nakedness of thy father's wife shalt thou not uncover: it is thy father's nakedness.</i> | You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your father's wife; it is Your father's nakedness. |

- 9 *The nakedness of thy sister, the daughter of thy father, or daughter of thy mother, whether she be born at home, or born abroad, even their nakedness thou shalt not uncover.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your sister, Your father's daughter or Your mother's daughter, whether brought up in the family or in another home.
- 10 *The nakedness of thy son's daughter, or of thy daughter's daughter, even their nakedness thou shalt not uncover: for theirs is thine own nakedness.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your son's daughter or of Your daughter's daughter, for their nakedness is Your own nakedness.
- 11 *The nakedness of thy father's wife's daughter, begotten of thy father, she is thy sister, thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your father's wife's daughter, brought up by Your father, since she is Your sister.
- 12 *Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father's sister: she is thy father's near kinswoman.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your father's sister; she is Your father's relative.
- 13 *Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother's sister: for she is thy mother's near kinswoman.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your mother's sister, for she is Your mother's relative.
- 14 *Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father's brother, thou shalt not approach to his wife: she is thine aunt.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your father's brother, that is, You shall not approach his wife; she is Your aunt.
- 15 *Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy daughter in law: she is thy son's wife; thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your daughter-in-law; she is Your son's wife, You shall not uncover her nakedness.
- 16 *Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy brother's wife: it is thy brother's nakedness.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of Your brother's wife; it is Your brother's nakedness.

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| <p>17 <i>Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of a woman and her daughter, neither shalt thou take her son's daughter, or her daughter's daughter, to uncover her nakedness; for they are her near kinswomen: it is wickedness.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Neither shalt thou take a wife to her sister, to vex her, to uncover her nakedness, beside the other in her life time.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Also thou shalt not approach unto a woman to uncover her nakedness, as long as she is put apart for her uncleanness.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Moreover thou shalt not lie carnally with thy neighbour's wife, to defile thyself with her.</i></p> | <p>You shall not uncover the nakedness of a woman and of her daughter, and you shall not take her son's daughter or her daughter's daughter to uncover her nakedness; they are relatives; it is depravity.</p> <p>you shall not take a woman as a rival wife to her sister, uncovering her nakedness while her sister is still alive.</p> <p>You shall not approach a woman to uncover her nakedness while she is in her menstrual uncleanness.</p> <p>you shall not lie sexually with Your neighbor's wife and so make Yourself unclean with her.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Molech (MO-lek) — "King" A pagan god worshipped by Canaanite peoples to whom children were sacrificed by fire. Worship of Molech was punishable by death under the Law. Also spelled Moloch.

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| <p>21 <i>And thou shalt not let any of thy seed pass through the fire to Molech, neither shalt thou profane the name of thy God: I am the LORD.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Thou shalt not lie with mankind, as with womankind: it is abomination.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Neither shalt thou lie with any beast to defile thyself therewith: neither shall any woman stand before a beast to lie down thereto: it is confusion.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Defile not ye yourselves in any of these things: for in all these the nations are defiled which I cast out before you:</i></p> | <p>You shall not give any of Your children to offer them to Molech, and so profane the name of Your God: I am the LORD.</p> <p>You shall not lie with a male as with a woman; it is an abomination.</p> <p>you shall not lie with any animal and so make Yourself unclean with it, neither shall any woman give herself to an animal to lie with it: it is perversion.</p> <p>Do not make yourselves unclean by any of these things, for by all these the nations I am driving out before you have become unclean,</p> |
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- 25 *And the land is defiled: therefore I do visit the iniquity thereof upon it, and the land itself vomiteth out her inhabitants.* the land became unclean, so that I punished its iniquity, and the land vomited out its inhabitants.
- 26 *Ye shall therefore keep my statutes and my judgments, and shall not commit any of these abominations; neither any of your own nation, nor any stranger that sojourneth among you:* But You shall keep my statutes and my rules and do none of these abominations, either the native or the stranger who sojourns among You
- 27 *(For all these abominations have the men of the land done, which were before you, and the land is defiled;)* (for the people of the land, who were before you, did all of these abominations, so that the land became unclean),
- 28 *That the land spue not you out also, when ye defile it, as it spued out the nations that were before you.* lest the land vomit You out when You make it unclean, as it vomited out the nations that were before you.
- 29 *For whosoever shall commit any of these abominations, even the souls that commit them shall be cut off from among their people.* For everyone who does any of these abominations, the persons who do them shall be cut off from among their people.
- 30 *Therefore shall ye keep mine ordinance, that ye commit not any one of these abominable customs, which were committed before you, and that ye defile not yourselves therein: I am the LORD your God.* So keep my charge never to practice any of these abominable customs that were practiced before You, and never to make yourselves unclean by them: I am the LORD Your God.'

Words in this chapter:

Canaan (KAY-nan) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 6:7; Lev 11:44

v3 — Ex 23:24; Lev 20:23; Ezek 20:7-8; 1 Pet 4:2-4; Ezek 23:8

v5 — Gal 3:12; Ezek 20:11; Rom 10:5; Ezek 20:21; Ezek 20:13

- v8 — Lev 20:11; Deut 27:20; 1 Cor 5:1; Deut 22:30
 v17 — Lev 20:14
 v19 — Lev 20:18; Lev 15:24
 v21 — Deut 12:31; Deut 18:10; Lev 20:2-5; Lev 19:12; Lev 22:32
 v22 — Lev 20:13; Rom 1:26-27; 1 Cor 6:9; 1 Tim 1:10; Jude 1:7
 v24 — Deut 18:12; Lev 18:30; Lev 20:22-23
 v25 — Lev 18:28; Lev 20:22-23; Jer 2:7; Jer 9:9; Ps 106:38
 v28 — Lev 20:22; Rev 3:16; Lev 18:25
 v30 — Lev 20:23; Deut 18:9-12

Chapter 19

The LORD commands Israel to be holy as He is holy, giving a wide range of laws covering reverence for parents, Sabbath-keeping, honest dealings, care for the poor and the stranger, just weights, and the command to love your neighbor as yourself.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, and say unto them, Ye shall be holy: for I the LORD your God am holy.</i> | 'Speak to all the congregation of the children of Israel and say to them, You shall be holy, for I the LORD Your God am holy. |
| 3 | <i>Ye shall fear every man his mother, and his father, and keep my sabbaths: I am the LORD your God.</i> | Every one of you shall revere his mother and his father, and You shall keep my Sabbaths: I am the LORD Your God. |
| 4 | <i>Turn ye not unto idols, nor make to yourselves molten gods: I am the LORD your God.</i> | Do not turn to idols or make for yourselves any gods of cast metal: I am the LORD Your God. |
| 5 | <i>And if ye offer a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD, ye shall offer it at your own will.</i> | When You offer a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD, You shall offer it so that You may be accepted. |
| 6 | <i>It shall be eaten the same day ye offer it, and on the morrow: and if ought remain until the third day, it shall be burnt in the fire.</i> | It shall be eaten the same day You offer it or on the day after, and anything left over until the third day shall be burned up with fire. |

- 7 *And if it be eaten at all on the third day, it is abominable; it shall not be accepted.* If it is eaten at all on the third day, it is tainted; it will not be accepted,
- 8 *Therefore every one that eateth it shall bear his iniquity, because he hath profaned the hallowed thing of the LORD: and that soul shall be cut off from among his people.* everyone who eats it shall bear His iniquity, because He has profaned what is holy to the LORD, and that person shall be cut off from His people.
- 9 *And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not wholly reap the corners of thy field, neither shalt thou gather the gleanings of thy harvest.* When You reap the harvest of Your land, You shall not reap Your field right up to its edge, neither shall You gather the gleanings after Your harvest.
- 10 *And thou shalt not glean thy vineyard, neither shalt thou gather every grape of thy vineyard; thou shalt leave them for the poor and stranger: I am the LORD your God.* you shall not strip Your vineyard bare, neither shall You gather the fallen grapes of Your vineyard. You shall leave them for the poor and for the sojourner: I am the LORD Your God.
- 11 *Ye shall not steal, neither deal falsely, neither lie one to another.* You shall not steal; You shall not deal falsely; You shall not lie to one another.
- 12 *And ye shall not swear by my name falsely, neither shalt thou profane the name of thy God: I am the LORD.* You shall not swear by my name falsely, and so profane the name of Your God: I am the LORD.
- 13 *Thou shalt not defraud thy neighbour, neither rob him: the wages of him that is hired shall not abide with thee all night until the morning.* You shall not oppress Your neighbor or rob Him. The wages of a hired worker shall not remain with you all night until the morning.
- 14 *Thou shalt not curse the deaf, nor put a stumblingblock before the blind, but shalt fear thy God: I am the LORD.* You shall not curse the deaf or put a stumbling block before the blind, but You shall fear Your God: I am the LORD.

- 15 *Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment: thou shalt not respect the person of the poor, nor honour the person of the mighty: but in righteousness shalt thou judge thy neighbour.* You shall do no injustice in court. You shall not be partial to the poor or defer to the great, but in righteousness shall You judge Your neighbor.
- 16 *Thou shalt not go up and down as a talebearer among thy people: neither shalt thou stand against the blood of thy neighbour: I am the LORD.* You shall not go around as a slanderer among Your people, and You shall not stand up against the life of Your neighbor: I am the LORD.
- 17 *Thou shalt not hate thy brother in thine heart: thou shalt in any wise rebuke thy neighbour, and not suffer sin upon him.* You shall not hate Your brother in Your heart, but You shall reason frankly with Your neighbor, lest You incur sin because of Him.
- 18 *Thou shalt not avenge, nor bear any grudge against the children of thy people, but thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself: I am the LORD.* You shall not take vengeance or bear a grudge against the sons of Your own people, but You shall love Your neighbor as Yourself: I am the LORD.
- 19 *Ye shall keep my statutes. Thou shalt not let thy cattle gender with a diverse kind: thou shalt not sow thy field with mingled seed: neither shall a garment mingled of linen and woollen come upon thee.* You shall keep my statutes. You shall not let Your cattle breed with a different kind. You shall not sow Your field with two kinds of seed, nor shall You wear a garment of cloth made of two kinds of material.
- 20 *And whosoever lieth carnally with a woman, that is a bondmaid, betrothed to an husband, and not at all redeemed, nor freedom given her; she shall be scourged; they shall not be put to death, because she was not free.* If a man lies sexually with a woman who is a slave, assigned to another man and not yet ransomed or given her freedom, she shall be punished. They shall not be put to death, because she was not free.
- 21 *And he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, even a ram for a trespass offering.* But He shall bring His guilt offering to the LORD, to the entrance of the tent of meeting, a ram for a guilt offering.

- 22 *And the priest shall make an atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering before the LORD for his sin which he hath done: and the sin which he hath done shall be forgiven him.* the priest shall make atonement for him with the ram of the guilt offering before the LORD for His sin that He has committed. He shall be forgiven for the sin that He has committed.
- 23 *And when ye shall come into the land, and shall have planted all manner of trees for food, then ye shall count the fruit thereof as uncircumcised: three years shall it be as uncircumcised unto you: it shall not be eaten of.* When You come into the land and plant any kind of tree for food, then You shall treat its fruit as forbidden. Three years it shall be forbidden to You; it must not be eaten.
- 24 *But in the fourth year all the fruit thereof shall be holy to praise the LORD withal.* in the fourth year all its fruit shall be holy, an offering of praise to the LORD.
- 25 *And in the fifth year shall ye eat of the fruit thereof, that it may yield unto you the increase thereof: I am the LORD your God.* But in the fifth year You may eat of its fruit, to increase its yield for You: I am the LORD Your God.
- 26 *Ye shall not eat any thing with the blood: neither shall ye use enchantment, nor observe times.* You shall not eat any flesh with the blood in it. You shall not practice augury or witchcraft.
- 27 *Ye shall not round the corners of your heads, neither shalt thou mar the corners of thy beard.* You shall not round off the hair on Your temples or mar the edges of Your beard.
- 28 *Ye shall not make any cuttings in your flesh for the dead, nor print any marks upon you: I am the LORD.* You shall not make any cuts on Your body for the dead or tattoo yourselves: I am the LORD.
- 29 *Do not prostitute thy daughter, to cause her to be a whore; lest the land fall to whoredom, and the land become full of wickedness.* Do not profane Your daughter by making her a prostitute, lest the land fall into prostitution and the land become full of depravity.

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| <p>30 <i>Ye shall keep my sabbaths, and reverence my sanctuary: I am the LORD.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Regard not them that have familiar spirits, neither seek after wizards, to be defiled by them: I am the LORD your God.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Thou shalt rise up before the hoary head, and honour the face of the old man, and fear thy God: I am the LORD.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And if a stranger sojourn with thee in your land, ye shall not vex him.</i></p> <p>34 <i>But the stranger that dwelleth with you shall be unto you as one born among you, and thou shalt love him as thyself; for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment, in meteyard, in weight, or in measure.</i></p> <p>36 <i>Just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin, shall ye have: I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt.</i></p> <p>37 <i>Therefore shall ye observe all my statutes, and all my judgments, and do them: I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>You shall keep my Sabbaths and reverence my sanctuary: I am the LORD.</p> <p>Do not turn to them that have familiar spirits, or to wizards; do not seek them out, and so make yourselves unclean by them: I am the LORD Your God.</p> <p>You shall stand up before the gray head and honor the face of an old man, and You shall fear Your God: I am the LORD.</p> <p>When a stranger sojourns with You in Your land, You shall not do Him wrong.</p> <p>You shall treat the stranger who sojourns with You as the native among You, and You shall love Him as Yourself, for You were strangers in the land of Egypt: I am the LORD Your God.</p> <p>You shall do no wrong in judgment, in measures of length or weight or quantity.</p> <p>You shall have just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin: I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt.</p> <p>you shall observe all my statutes and all my rules, and do them: I am the LORD.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Lev 11:44-45; Lev 20:7; 1 Pet 1:15-16; 2 Cor 6:14-16; Matt 5:48
- v3 — Ex 20:12; Ex 20:8; Eph 6:1-3; Heb 12:9; Ezek 22:7-8
- v4 — Lev 26:1; Ps 115:4-7; Ex 34:17; Ex 20:23; Ex 20:3-5
- v11 — Eph 4:25; Ex 20:15; Col 3:9; Ps 101:7; Zech 5:3-4
- v15 — Deut 1:17; Prov 24:23; Deut 27:19; Ex 23:2-3; Ex 23:6-8
- v16 — Ex 23:1; Ex 23:7; Prov 20:19; Ezek 22:9; Jer 9:4
- v17 — Luke 17:3; 1 John 2:9; 1 John 2:11; Prov 27:5-6; Prov 26:24-26
- v18 — Rom 13:9; Matt 22:39-40; Mark 12:31-34; Luke 10:27-37; Gal 5:14
- v19 — 2 Cor 6:14-17; Deut 22:9-11; Matt 9:16-17
- v28 — Deut 14:1; 1 Kgs 18:28; Lev 21:5; Lev 21:1; Jer 16:6
- v31 — Isa 8:19; Lev 20:27; Lev 20:6-7; 2 Chr 33:6; Deut 18:10-14
- v32 — 1 Tim 5:1; Prov 16:31; Lam 5:12; Prov 20:29; Job 32:6

Chapter 20

The LORD prescribes the death penalty for giving children to Molech, consulting familiar spirits, cursing one's parents, adultery, and various sexual sins listed in chapter 18. He calls Israel to be holy and separated from the nations.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Again, thou shalt say to the children of Israel, Whosoever he be of the children of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn in Israel, that giveth any of his seed to Molech; he shall surely be put to death: the people of the land shall stone him with stones.</i> | 'Say to the children of Israel, Any one of the children of Israel or of the strangers who stay in Israel who gives any of His children to Molech shall surely be put to death. The people of the land shall stone him with stones. |
| 3 | <i>And I will set my face against that man, and will cut him off from among his people; because he hath given of his seed to Molech, to defile my sanctuary, and to profane my holy name.</i> | I myself will set my face against that man and will cut him off from among his people, because He has given one of His children to Molech, to make my sanctuary unclean and to profane my holy name. |

- 4 *And if the people of the land do any ways hide their eyes from the man, when he giveth of his seed to Molech, and kill him not:* if the people of the land do at all close their eyes to that man when he gives one of his children to Molech, and do not put Him to death,
- 5 *Then I will set my face against that man, and against his family, and will cut him off, and all that go a whoring after him, to commit whoredom with Molech, from among their people.* then I will set my face against that man and against his clan and will cut them off from among their people, Him and all who follow Him in whoring after Molech.
- 6 *And the soul that turneth after such as have familiar spirits, and after wizards, to go a whoring after them, I will even set my face against that soul, and will cut him off from among his people.* If a person turns to such as have familiar spirits, and after wizards, to go whoring after them, I will set my face against that person and will cut Him off from among His people.
- 7 *Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be ye holy: for I am the LORD your God.* Consecrate yourselves, therefore, and be holy, for I am the LORD Your God.
- 8 *And ye shall keep my statutes, and do them: I am the LORD which sanctify you.* Keep my statutes and do them; I am the LORD Who sanctifies You.
- 9 *For every one that curseth his father or his mother shall be surely put to death: he hath cursed his father or his mother; his blood shall be upon him.* For anyone who curses his father or his mother shall surely be put to death; He has cursed His father or His mother; His blood is upon Him.
- 10 *And the man that committeth adultery with another man's wife, even he that committeth adultery with his neighbour's wife, the adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death.* If a man commits adultery with the wife of his neighbor, both the adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death.
- 11 *And the man that lieth with his father's wife hath uncovered his father's nakedness: both of them shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.* If a man lies with his father's wife, he has uncovered His father's nakedness; both of them shall surely be put to death; their blood is upon them.

- 12 *And if a man lie with his daughter in law, both of them shall surely be put to death: they have wrought confusion; their blood shall be upon them.* If a man lies with his daughter-in-law, both of them shall surely be put to death; they have committed perversion; their blood is upon them.
- 13 *If a man also lie with mankind, as he lieth with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.* If a man lies with a male as with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination; they shall surely be put to death; their blood is upon them.
- 14 *And if a man take a wife and her mother, it is wickedness: they shall be burnt with fire, both he and they; that there be no wickedness among you.* If a man takes a woman and her mother also, it is depravity; he and they shall be burned with fire, that there may be no depravity among You.
- 15 *And if a man lie with a beast, he shall surely be put to death: and ye shall slay the beast.* If a man lies with an animal, he shall surely be put to death, and You shall kill the animal.
- 16 *And if a woman approach unto any beast, and lie down thereto, thou shalt kill the woman, and the beast: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.* If a woman approaches any animal and lies with it, you shall kill the woman and the animal; they shall surely be put to death; their blood is upon them.
- 17 *And if a man shall take his sister, his father's daughter, or his mother's daughter, and see her nakedness, and she see his nakedness; it is a wicked thing; and they shall be cut off in the sight of their people: he hath uncovered his sister's nakedness; he shall bear his iniquity.* If a man takes his sister, a daughter of his father or a daughter of his mother, and sees her nakedness, and she sees his nakedness, it is a disgrace. They shall be cut off in the sight of the children of their people. He has uncovered his sister's nakedness. He shall bear his iniquity.

- 18 *And if a man shall lie with a woman having her sickness, and shall uncover her nakedness; he hath discovered her fountain, and she hath uncovered the fountain of her blood: and both of them shall be cut off from among their people.* If a man lies with a woman during her menstrual period and uncovers her nakedness, he has made naked her fountain. She has uncovered the fountain of her blood. Both of them shall be cut off from among their people.
- 19 *And thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother's sister, nor of thy father's sister: for he uncovereth his near kin: they shall bear their iniquity.* You shall not uncover the nakedness of your mother's sister or of your father's sister, for that is to make naked one's relative; they shall bear their iniquity.
- 20 *And if a man shall lie with his uncle's wife, he hath uncovered his uncle's nakedness: they shall bear their sin; they shall die childless.* If a man lies with his uncle's wife, he has uncovered his uncle's nakedness; they shall bear their sin; they shall die childless.
- 21 *And if a man shall take his brother's wife, it is an unclean thing: he hath uncovered his brother's nakedness; they shall be childless.* If a man takes his brother's wife, it is impurity. He has uncovered his brother's nakedness; they shall be childless.
- 22 *Ye shall therefore keep all my statutes, and all my judgments, and do them: that the land, whither I bring you to dwell therein, spue you not out.* You shall therefore keep all my statutes and all my rules and do them, that the land where I am bringing you to live may not vomit you out.
- 23 *And ye shall not walk in the manners of the nation, which I cast out before you: for they committed all these things, and therefore I abhorred them.* you shall not walk in the customs of the nation that I am driving out before you, for they did all these things, and therefore I detested them.
- 24 *But I have said unto you, Ye shall inherit their land, and I will give it unto you to possess it, a land that floweth with milk and honey: I am the LORD your God, which have separated you from other people.* But I have said to You, You shall inherit their land. I will give it to You to possess, a land flowing with milk and honey. I am the LORD Your God, Who has separated You from the peoples.

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| <p>25 <i>Ye shall therefore put difference between clean beasts and unclean, and between unclean fowls and clean: and ye shall not make your souls abominable by beast, or by fowl, or by any manner of living thing that creepeth on the ground, which I have separated from you as unclean.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And ye shall be holy unto me: for I the LORD am holy, and have severed you from other people, that ye should be mine.</i></p> <p>27 <i>A man also or woman that hath a familiar spirit, or that is a wizard, shall surely be put to death: they shall stone them with stones: their blood shall be upon them.</i></p> | <p>You shall therefore separate the clean beast from the unclean, and the unclean bird from the clean. You shall not make yourselves detestable by beast or by bird or by anything with which the ground crawls, which I have set apart for You to hold unclean.</p> <p>You shall be holy to me, for I the LORD am holy and have separated You from the peoples, that You should be mine.</p> <p>A man or a woman who is a familiar spirit, or that is a wizard shall surely be put to death. They shall be stoned with stones; their blood shall be upon them.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Lev 19:31; Isa 8:19; 1 Chr 10:13-14; Lev 20:27; Deut 18:10-14
- v7 — Lev 11:44; Lev 19:2; 1 Pet 1:15-16; Eph 1:4; Col 3:12
- v8 — Jas 1:22; Ex 31:13
- v9 — Ex 21:17; Mark 7:10; Deut 27:16; Matt 15:4; Prov 20:20
- v10 — John 8:4-5; Deut 22:22-24; Deut 5:18
- v13 — 1 Cor 6:9; Lev 18:22; Jude 1:7; 1 Tim 1:10; Deut 23:17
- v14 — Lev 18:17; Deut 27:23
- v15 — Lev 18:23; Deut 27:21; Ex 22:19
- v23 — Lev 18:24; Deut 9:5; Lev 18:30; Lev 18:3
- v24 — Deut 14:2; Ex 3:8; Ex 3:17; Ex 6:8; Deut 7:6
- v26 — 1 Pet 1:15-16; Lev 20:7; Lev 20:24; Lev 19:2; Deut 7:6

v27 — Lev 19:31; Lev 20:6

Chapter 21

The LORD gives laws restricting how priests may mourn and whom they may marry. The high priest must not uncover his head or tear his clothes in mourning, and no descendant of Aaron with a physical blemish may approach the altar to offer the bread of God.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Speak unto the priests the sons of Aaron, and say unto them, There shall none be defiled for the dead among his people:</i></p> <p>2 <i>But for his kin, that is near unto him, that is, for his mother, and for his father, and for his son, and for his daughter, and for his brother,</i></p> <p>3 <i>And for his sister a virgin, that is nigh unto him, which hath had no husband; for her may he be defiled.</i></p> <p>4 <i>But he shall not defile himself, being a chief man among his people, to profane himself.</i></p> <p>5 <i>They shall not make baldness upon their head, neither shall they shave off the corner of their beard, nor make any cuttings in their flesh.</i></p> <p>6 <i>They shall be holy unto their God, and not profane the name of their God: for the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and the bread of their God, they do offer: therefore they shall be holy.</i></p> <p>7 <i>They shall not take a wife that is a whore, or profane; neither shall they take a woman put away from her husband: for he is holy unto his God.</i></p> | <p>the LORD said to Moses, 'Speak to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and say to them, No one shall make himself unclean for the dead among his people,</p> <p>except for His closest relatives, His mother, His father, His son, His daughter, His brother,</p> <p>or His virgin sister (who is near to Him because she has had no husband; for her He may make Himself unclean).</p> <p>He shall not make Himself unclean as a chief man among His people and so profane Himself.</p> <p>They shall not make bald patches on their heads, nor shave off the edges of their beards, nor make any cuts on their body.</p> <p>They shall be holy to their God and not profane the name of their God. For they offer the LORD's offerings made by fire, the bread of their God; therefore they shall be holy.</p> <p>They shall not marry a prostitute or a woman who has been defiled, neither shall they marry a woman divorced from her husband, for the priest is holy to his God.</p> |
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- 8 *Thou shalt sanctify him therefore; for he offereth the bread of thy God: he shall be holy unto thee: for I the LORD, which sanctify you, am holy.* You shall sanctify Him, for He offers the bread of Your God. He shall be holy to You, for I, the LORD, Who sanctify You, am holy.
- 9 *And the daughter of any priest, if she profane herself by playing the whore, she profaneth her father: she shall be burnt with fire.* the daughter of any priest, if she profanes herself by whoring, profanes her father; she shall be burned with fire.
- 10 *And he that is the high priest among his brethren, upon whose head the anointing oil was poured, and that is consecrated to put on the garments, shall not uncover his head, nor rend his clothes;* The priest who is chief among his brothers, on whose head the anointing oil is poured and who has been consecrated to wear the garments, shall not let the hair of his head hang loose nor tear his clothes.
- 11 *Neither shall he go in to any dead body, nor defile himself for his father, or for his mother;* He shall not go in to any dead bodies nor make himself unclean, even for his father or for his mother.
- 12 *Neither shall he go out of the sanctuary, nor profane the sanctuary of his God; for the crown of the anointing oil of his God is upon him: I am the LORD.* He shall not go out of the sanctuary, lest He profane the sanctuary of His God, for the consecration of the anointing oil of His God is on Him: I am the LORD.
- 13 *And he shall take a wife in her virginity.* he shall take a wife in her virginity.
- 14 *A widow, or a divorced woman, or profane, or an harlot, these shall he not take: but he shall take a virgin of his own people to wife.* A widow, or a divorced woman, or a woman who has been defiled, or a prostitute — these He shall not marry. But He shall take as his wife a virgin of His own people,
- 15 *Neither shall he profane his seed among his people: for I the LORD do sanctify him.* that He may not profane His seed among His people, for I am the LORD Who sanctifies Him.'
- 16 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 17 *Speak unto Aaron, saying, Whosoever he be of thy seed in their generations that hath any blemish, let him not approach to offer the bread of his God.* 'Speak to Aaron, saying, None of your seed throughout their generations who has a blemish may approach to offer the bread of his God.
- 18 *For whatsoever man he be that hath a blemish, he shall not approach: a blind man, or a lame, or he that hath a flat nose, or any thing superfluous,* For no one who has a blemish shall draw near, a man blind or lame, or one who has a mutilated face or a limb too long,
- 19 *Or a man that is brokenfooted, or brokenhanded,* or a man who has an injured foot or an injured hand,
- 20 *Or crookbackt, or a dwarf, or that hath a blemish in his eye, or be scurvy, or scabbed, or hath his stones broken:* or a hunchback or a dwarf or a man with a defect in his sight or an itching disease or scabs or crushed testicles.
- 21 *No man that hath a blemish of the seed of Aaron the priest shall come nigh to offer the offerings of the LORD made by fire: he hath a blemish; he shall not come nigh to offer the bread of his God.* No man of the seed of Aaron the priest who has a blemish shall come near to offer the LORD's offerings made by fire; since He has a blemish, He shall not come near to offer the bread of His God.
- 22 *He shall eat the bread of his God, both of the most holy, and of the holy.* He may eat the bread of His God, both of the most holy and of the holy things,
- 23 *Only he shall not go in unto the vail, nor come nigh unto the altar, because he hath a blemish; that he profane not my sanctuaries: for I the LORD do sanctify them.* but He shall not go through the veil or approach the altar, because He has a blemish, that He may not profane my sanctuaries, for I am the LORD Who sanctifies them.'
- 24 *And Moses told it unto Aaron, and to his sons, and unto all the children of Israel.* So Moses spoke to Aaron and to his sons and to all the children of Israel.

Words in this chapter:

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ezek 44:25
v5 — Deut 14:1; Ezek 44:20
v6 — Lev 18:21; Lev 3:11
v7 — Lev 21:13-14; Ezek 44:22
v8 — Lev 20:7-8; Lev 19:2; Lev 11:44-45
v9 — Gen 38:24
v10 — Lev 10:6-7; Lev 16:32; Matt 26:65
v11 — Num 19:14
v20 — Deut 23:1
v21 — Lev 21:6

Chapter 22

The LORD gives laws requiring priests to avoid uncleanness when handling holy things, and specifying who in a priest's household may eat the holy food. Sacrificial animals must be without blemish, and no animal may be offered before it is eight days old.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> | <p>The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Speak unto Aaron and to his sons, that they separate themselves from the holy things of the children of Israel, and that they profane not my holy name in those things which they hallow unto me: I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>'Speak to Aaron and his sons so that they keep away from the holy things of the children of Israel, which they dedicate to me, so that they do not profane my holy name: I am the LORD.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Say unto them, Whosoever he be of all your seed among your generations, that goeth unto the holy things, which the children of Israel hallow unto the LORD, having his uncleanness upon him, that soul shall be cut off from my presence: I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Say to them, If any one of all Your seed throughout Your generations approaches the holy things that the children of Israel dedicate to the LORD, while He has an uncleanness, that person shall be cut off from my presence: I am the LORD.</p> |

- 4 *What man soever of the seed of Aaron is a leper, or hath a running issue; he shall not eat of the holy things, until he be clean. And whoso toucheth any thing that is unclean by the dead, or a man whose seed goeth from him;* None of the seed of Aaron who has a skin disease or a discharge may eat of the holy things until he is clean. Whoever touches anything that is unclean through contact with the dead or a man who has had an emission of semen,
- 5 *Or whosoever toucheth any creeping thing, whereby he may be made unclean, or a man of whom he may take uncleanness, whatsoever uncleanness he hath;* whoever touches a swarming thing by which he may be made unclean or a person from whom he may take uncleanness, whatever his uncleanness may be —
- 6 *The soul which hath touched any such shall be unclean until even, and shall not eat of the holy things, unless he wash his flesh with water.* the person who touches any such thing shall be unclean until the evening and shall not eat of the holy things unless he has bathed his body in water.
- 7 *And when the sun is down, he shall be clean, and shall afterward eat of the holy things; because it is his food.* When the sun goes down he shall be clean, and afterward he may eat of the holy things, because they are his food.
- 8 *That which dieth of itself, or is torn with beasts, he shall not eat to defile himself therewith: I am the LORD.* He shall not eat what dies of itself or is torn by beasts, and so make Himself unclean by it: I am the LORD.
- 9 *They shall therefore keep mine ordinance, lest they bear sin for it, and die therefore, if they profane it: I the LORD do sanctify them.* They shall therefore keep my charge, lest they bear sin for it and die thereby when they profane it: I am the LORD Who sanctifies them.
- 10 *There shall no stranger eat of the holy thing: a sojourner of the priest, or an hired servant, shall not eat of the holy thing.* A lay person shall not eat of a holy thing; no foreign guest of the priest or hired worker shall eat of a holy thing.
- 11 *But if the priest buy any soul with his money, he shall eat of it, and he that is born in his house: they shall eat of his meat.* But if a priest buys a slave as his property for money, the slave may eat of it, and anyone born in his house may eat of his food.

- 12 *If the priest's daughter also be married unto a stranger, she may not eat of an offering of the holy things.* If a priest's daughter marries a layman, she shall not eat of the contribution of the holy things.
- 13 *But if the priest's daughter be a widow, or divorced, and have no child, and is returned unto her father's house, as in her youth, she shall eat of her father's meat: but there shall no stranger eat thereof.* But if a priest's daughter is widowed or divorced and has no children and returns to her father's house, as in her youth, she may eat of her father's food; yet no lay person shall eat of it.
- 14 *And if a man eat of the holy thing unwittingly, then he shall put the fifth part thereof unto it, and shall give it unto the priest with the holy thing.* if anyone eats of a holy thing unintentionally, he shall add the fifth of its value to it and give the holy thing to the priest.
- 15 *And they shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, which they offer unto the LORD;* They shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, which they contribute to the LORD,
- 16 *Or suffer them to bear the iniquity of trespass, when they eat their holy things: for I the LORD do sanctify them.* so cause them to bear iniquity and guilt, by eating their holy things: for I am the LORD Who sanctifies them.'
- 17 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 18 *Speak unto Aaron, and to his sons, and unto all the children of Israel, and say unto them, Whatsoever he be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers in Israel, that will offer his oblation for all his vows, and for all his freewill offerings, which they will offer unto the LORD for a burnt offering;* 'Speak to Aaron and his sons and all the children of Israel and say to them, When any one of the house of Israel or of the sojourners in Israel presents a burnt offering as His offering, for any of their vows or freewill offerings that they offer to the LORD,
- 19 *Ye shall offer at your own will a male without blemish, of the beeves, of the sheep, or of the goats.* if it is to be accepted for You it shall be a male without blemish, of the bulls or the sheep or the goats.

- 20 *But whatsoever hath a blemish, that shall ye not offer: for it shall not be acceptable for you.* You shall not offer anything that has a blemish, for it will not be acceptable for You.
- 21 *And whosoever offereth a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD to accomplish his vow, or a freewill offering in beeves or sheep, it shall be perfect to be accepted; there shall be no blemish therein.* when anyone offers a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD to fulfill a vow or as a freewill offering from the herd or flock, to be accepted it must be perfect; there shall be no blemish in it.
- 22 *Blind, or broken, or maimed, or having a wen, or scurvy, or scabbed, ye shall not offer these unto the LORD, nor make an offering by fire of them upon the altar unto the LORD.* Animals blind or disabled or mutilated or having a discharge or an itch or scabs You shall not offer to the LORD or give them to the LORD as a offering made by fire on the altar.
- 23 *Either a bullock or a lamb that hath any thing superfluous or lacking in his parts, that mayest thou offer for a freewill offering; but for a vow it shall not be accepted.* You may present a bull or a lamb that has a part too long or too short for a freewill offering, but for a vow offering it cannot be accepted.
- 24 *Ye shall not offer unto the LORD that which is bruised, or crushed, or broken, or cut; neither shall ye make any offering thereof in your land.* Any animal that has its testicles bruised or crushed or torn or cut You shall not offer to the LORD; You shall not do it within Your land.
- 25 *Neither from a stranger's hand shall ye offer the bread of your God of any of these; because their corruption is in them, and blemishes be in them: they shall not be accepted for you.* Neither shall You offer as the bread of Your God any such animals gotten from a foreigner. Since there is a blemish in them, because of their mutilation, they will not be accepted for You.'
- 26 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 27 *When a bullock, or a sheep, or a goat, is brought forth, then it shall be seven days under the dam; and from the eighth day and thenceforth it shall be accepted for an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* When an ox or sheep or goat is born, it shall remain seven days with its mother, and from the eighth day on it shall be acceptable as a offering made by fire to the LORD.
- 28 *And whether it be cow or ewe, ye shall not kill it and her young both in one day.* But You shall not kill an ox or a sheep and her young in the same day.
- 29 *And when ye will offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving unto the LORD, offer it at your own will.* when You sacrifice a sacrifice of thanksgiving to the LORD, You shall sacrifice it so that You may be accepted.
- 30 *On the same day it shall be eaten up; ye shall leave none of it until the morrow: I am the LORD.* It shall be eaten on the same day; You shall leave none of it until morning: I am the LORD.
- 31 *Therefore shall ye keep my commandments, and do them: I am the LORD.* So You shall keep my commandments and do them: I am the LORD.
- 32 *Neither shall ye profane my holy name; but I will be hallowed among the children of Israel: I am the LORD which hallow you,* you shall not profane my holy name, that I may be sanctified among the children of Israel. I am the LORD Who sanctifies You,
- 33 *That brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: I am the LORD.* who brought You out of the land of Egypt to be Your God: I am the LORD.'

Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

v9 — Ex 28:43

v15 — Num 18:32

v16 — Lev 22:9

v18 — Lev 1:2

v20 — Deut 17:1; Deut 15:21; Mal 1:8

v21 — Num 15:8; Num 15:3

v22 — Lev 22:20

v27 — Ex 22:30

v28 — Deut 22:6-7

v31 — Deut 4:40

v32 — Luke 11:2; Lev 18:21

Chapter 23

The LORD establishes Israel's appointed feasts: the weekly Sabbath, Passover and Unleavened Bread, Firstfruits, the Feast of Weeks, the Feast of Trumpets, the Day of Atonement, and the Feast of Tabernacles. Each feast has specific dates, offerings, and observances.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| <p>2 <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, Concerning the feasts of the LORD, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my feasts.</i></p> | 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, These are the appointed feasts of the LORD that You shall proclaim as holy convocations; they are my appointed feasts. |
| <p>3 <i>Six days shall work be done: but the seventh day is the sabbath of rest, an holy convocation; ye shall do no work therein: it is the sabbath of the LORD in all your dwellings.</i></p> | Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest, a holy convocation. You shall do no work. It is a Sabbath to the LORD in all Your dwelling places. |
| <p>4 <i>These are the feasts of the LORD, even holy convocations, which ye shall proclaim in their seasons.</i></p> | These are the appointed feasts of the LORD, the holy convocations, which You shall proclaim at the time appointed for them. |
| <p>5 <i>In the fourteenth day of the first month at even is the LORD's passover.</i></p> | In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at twilight, is the LORD's Passover. |
| <p>6 <i>And on the fifteenth day of the same month is the feast of unleavened bread unto the LORD: seven days ye must eat unleavened bread.</i></p> | on the fifteenth day of the same month is the Feast of Unleavened Bread to the LORD; for seven days You shall eat unleavened bread. |

- 7 *In the first day ye shall have an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.* On the first day You shall have a holy convocation; You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 8 *But ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD seven days: in the seventh day is an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.* But You shall present a offering made by fire to the LORD for seven days. On the seventh day is a holy convocation; You shall not do any ordinary work.'
- 9 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 10 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye be come into the land which I give unto you, and shall reap the harvest thereof, then ye shall bring a sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest unto the priest:* 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, When you come into the land that I give you and reap its harvest, you shall bring the sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest to the priest,
- 11 *And he shall wave the sheaf before the LORD, to be accepted for you: on the morrow after the sabbath the priest shall wave it.* he shall wave the sheaf before the LORD, so that You may be accepted. On the day after the Sabbath the priest shall wave it.
- 12 *And ye shall offer that day when ye wave the sheaf an he lamb without blemish of the first year for a burnt offering unto the LORD.* on the day when You wave the sheaf, You shall offer a male lamb a year old without blemish as a burnt offering to the LORD.
- 13 *And the meat offering thereof shall be two tenth deals of fine flour mingled with oil, an offering made by fire unto the LORD for a sweet savour: and the drink offering thereof shall be of wine, the fourth part of an hin.* the grain offering with it shall be two tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil, a offering made by fire to the LORD with a sweet savour, and the drink offering with it shall be of wine, a fourth of a hin.

- 14 *And ye shall eat neither bread, nor parched corn, nor green ears, until the selfsame day that ye have brought an offering unto your God: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations in all your dwellings.* you shall eat neither bread nor grain parched or fresh until this same day, until You have brought the offering of Your God: it is a statute forever throughout Your generations in all Your dwelling places.
- 15 *And ye shall count unto you from the morrow after the sabbath, from the day that ye brought the sheaf of the wave offering; seven sabbaths shall be complete:* You shall count seven full weeks from the day after the Sabbath, from the day that You brought the sheaf of the wave offering.
- 16 *Even unto the morrow after the seventh sabbath shall ye number fifty days; and ye shall offer a new meat offering unto the LORD.* You shall count fifty days to the day after the seventh Sabbath. Then You shall present a grain offering of new grain to the LORD.
- 17 *Ye shall bring out of your habitations two wave loaves of two tenth deals: they shall be of fine flour; they shall be baked with leaven; they are the firstfruits unto the LORD.* You shall bring from Your dwelling places two loaves of bread to be waved, made of two tenths of an ephah. They shall be of fine flour. They shall be baked with leaven, as firstfruits to the LORD.
- 18 *And ye shall offer with the bread seven lambs without blemish of the first year, and one young bullock, and two rams: they shall be for a burnt offering unto the LORD, with their meat offering, and their drink offerings, even an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* you shall present with the bread seven lambs a year old without blemish, and one bull from the herd and two rams. They shall be a burnt offering to the LORD, with their grain offering and their drink offerings, a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 19 *Then ye shall sacrifice one kid of the goats for a sin offering, and two lambs of the first year for a sacrifice of peace offerings.* you shall offer one male goat for a sin offering, and two male lambs a year old as a sacrifice of peace offerings.

- 20 *And the priest shall wave them with the bread of the firstfruits for a wave offering before the LORD, with the two lambs: they shall be holy to the LORD for the priest.* the priest shall wave them with the bread of the firstfruits as a wave offering before the LORD, with the two lambs. They shall be holy to the LORD for the priest.
- 21 *And ye shall proclaim on the selfsame day, that it may be an holy convocation unto you: ye shall do no servile work therein: it shall be a statute for ever in all your dwellings throughout your generations.* you shall make a proclamation on the same day. You shall hold a holy convocation. You shall not do any ordinary work. It is a statute forever in all Your dwelling places throughout Your generations.
- 22 *And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not make clean riddance of the corners of thy field when thou reapest, neither shalt thou gather any gleanings of thy harvest: thou shalt leave them unto the poor, and to the stranger: I am the LORD your God.* when You reap the harvest of Your land, You shall not reap Your field right up to its edge, nor shall You gather the gleanings after Your harvest. You shall leave them for the poor and for the sojourner: I am the LORD Your God.'
- 23 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 24 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, In the seventh month, in the first day of the month, shall ye have a sabbath, a memorial of blowing of trumpets, an holy convocation.* 'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, You shall observe a day of solemn rest, a memorial proclaimed with the blast of trumpets, a holy convocation.
- 25 *Ye shall do no servile work therein: but ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* You shall not do any ordinary work, and You shall present a offering made by fire to the LORD.'
- 26 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 27 *Also on the tenth day of this seventh month there shall be a day of atonement: it shall be an holy convocation unto you; and ye shall afflict your souls, and offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD.* 'Now on the tenth day of this seventh month is the Day of Atonement. It shall be for You a time of holy convocation, and You shall afflict yourselves and present a offering made by fire to the LORD.
- 28 *And ye shall do no work in that same day: for it is a day of atonement, to make an atonement for you before the LORD your God.* you shall not do any work on that very day, for it is a Day of Atonement, to make atonement for You before the LORD Your God.
- 29 *For whatsoever soul it be that shall not be afflicted in that same day, he shall be cut off from among his people.* For whoever is not afflicted on that very day shall be cut off from His people.
- 30 *And whatsoever soul it be that doeth any work in that same day, the same soul will I destroy from among his people.* whoever does any work on that very day, that person I will destroy from among His people.
- 31 *Ye shall do no manner of work: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations in all your dwellings.* You shall not do any work. It is a statute forever throughout Your generations in all Your dwelling places.
- 32 *It shall be unto you a sabbath of rest, and ye shall afflict your souls: in the ninth day of the month at even, from even unto even, shall ye celebrate your sabbath.* It shall be to You a Sabbath of solemn rest, and You shall afflict yourselves. On the ninth day of the month beginning at evening, from evening to evening shall You keep Your Sabbath.'
- 33 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 34 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, The fifteenth day of this seventh month shall be the feast of tabernacles for seven days unto the LORD.* 'Speak to the children of Israel, saying, On the fifteenth day of this seventh month and for seven days is the Feast of Booths to the LORD.

- 35 *On the first day shall be an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.* On the first day shall be a holy convocation; You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 36 *Seven days ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD: on the eighth day shall be an holy convocation unto you; and ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD: it is a solemn assembly; and ye shall do no servile work therein.* For seven days You shall present offerings made by fire to the LORD. On the eighth day You shall hold a holy convocation and present a offering made by fire to the LORD. It is a solemn assembly; You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 37 *These are the feasts of the LORD, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, to offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD, a burnt offering, and a meat offering, a sacrifice, and drink offerings, every thing upon his day:* These are the appointed feasts of the LORD, which You shall proclaim as times of holy convocation, for presenting to the LORD offerings made by fire, burnt offerings and grain offerings, sacrifices and drink offerings, each on its proper day,
- 38 *Beside the sabbaths of the LORD, and beside your gifts, and beside all your vows, and beside all your freewill offerings, which ye give unto the LORD.* besides the LORD's Sabbaths and besides Your gifts and besides all Your vow offerings and besides all Your freewill offerings, which You give to the LORD.
- 39 *Also in the fifteenth day of the seventh month, when ye have gathered in the fruit of the land, ye shall keep a feast unto the LORD seven days: on the first day shall be a sabbath, and on the eighth day shall be a sabbath.* On the fifteenth day of the seventh month, when You have gathered in the produce of the land, You shall celebrate the feast of the LORD seven days. On the first day shall be a solemn rest, and on the eighth day shall be a solemn rest.
- 40 *And ye shall take you on the first day the boughs of goodly trees, branches of palm trees, and the boughs of thick trees, and willows of the brook; and ye shall rejoice before the LORD your God seven days.* you shall take on the first day the fruit of splendid trees, branches of palm trees and boughs of leafy trees and willows of the brook, and You shall rejoice before the LORD Your God seven days.

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| <p>41 <i>And ye shall keep it a feast unto the LORD seven days in the year. It shall be a statute for ever in your generations: ye shall celebrate it in the seventh month.</i></p> <p>42 <i>Ye shall dwell in booths seven days; all that are Israelites born shall dwell in booths:</i></p> <p>43 <i>That your generations may know that I made the children of Israel to dwell in booths, when I brought them out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.</i></p> <p>44 <i>And Moses declared unto the children of Israel the feasts of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>You shall celebrate it as a feast to the LORD for seven days in the year. It is a statute forever throughout Your generations; You shall celebrate it in the seventh month.</p> <p>You shall dwell in booths for seven days. All native Israelites shall dwell in booths,</p> <p>that Your generations may know that I made the children of Israel dwell in booths when I brought them out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD Your God.'</p> <p>Thus Moses declared to the children of Israel the appointed feasts of the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Day of Atonement — Yom Kippur — the holiest day of Israel's year; the only day the high priest entered the Most Holy Place to make atonement for the nation's sins.

Feast of Tabernacles — Also called the Feast of Booths — a seven-day harvest festival where Israel lived in temporary shelters, remembering the wilderness wandering.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Lev 23:37; Lev 23:4
- v3 — Lev 19:3; Ex 35:2-3; Ex 23:12
- v5 — Josh 5:10; Deut 16:1-8; Num 28:16-17
- v10 — Ex 34:26; Ex 23:19
- v22 — Lev 19:9-10; Deut 24:19-21; Isa 58:10; Prov 11:24-25; Ruth 2:15-23
- v24 — 1 Thess 4:16; 1 Cor 15:52; Num 29:1-6; Lev 25:9; Num 10:9-10
- v27 — Lev 16:29-31; Ex 30:10; Lev 16:24; Lev 16:15; Num 29:7-11
- v34 — John 7:2; Neh 8:14; Num 29:12; Ezra 3:4
- v36 — Neh 8:18; John 7:37
- v37 — Lev 23:2; Lev 23:4
- v39 — Ex 23:16; Deut 16:13
- v40 — Rev 7:9; Phil 4:4; Deut 16:14-15; Matt 21:8

Chapter 24

The LORD commands pure olive oil to be kept burning continually in the lampstand and showbread to be set before Him every Sabbath. A man who blasphemed the name of the LORD was brought to Moses, and the LORD commanded that he be stoned; He then restates the law of eye for eye and tooth for tooth.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Command the children of Israel, that they bring unto thee pure oil olive beaten for the light, to cause the lamps to burn continually.</i> | 'Command the children of Israel to bring You pure oil from beaten olives for the lamp, that a light may be kept burning regularly. |
| 3 | <i>Without the vail of the testimony, in the tabernacle of the congregation, shall Aaron order it from the evening unto the morning before the LORD continually: it shall be a statute for ever in your generations.</i> | Outside the veil of the testimony, in the tent of meeting, Aaron shall tend it from evening to morning before the LORD regularly. It shall be a statute forever throughout Your generations. |
| 4 | <i>He shall order the lamps upon the pure candlestick before the LORD continually.</i> | He shall tend the lamps on the lampstand of pure gold before the LORD regularly. |
| 5 | <i>And thou shalt take fine flour, and bake twelve cakes thereof: two tenth deals shall be in one cake.</i> | You shall take fine flour and bake twelve loaves from it; two tenths of an ephah shall be in each loaf. |
| 6 | <i>And thou shalt set them in two rows, six on a row, upon the pure table before the LORD.</i> | you shall set them in two piles, six in a pile, on the table of pure gold before the LORD. |
| 7 | <i>And thou shalt put pure frankincense upon each row, that it may be on the bread for a memorial, even an offering made by fire unto the LORD.</i> | you shall put pure frankincense on each pile, that it may go with the bread as a memorial portion as a offering made by fire to the LORD. |
| 8 | <i>Every sabbath he shall set it in order before the LORD continually, being taken from the children of Israel by an everlasting covenant.</i> | Every Sabbath day Aaron shall arrange it before the LORD regularly; it is from the children of Israel as a covenant forever. |

- 9 *And it shall be Aaron's and his sons'; and they shall eat it in the holy place: for it is most holy unto him of the offerings of the LORD made by fire by a perpetual statute.* it shall be for Aaron and his sons. They shall eat it in a holy place, since it is for Him a most holy portion out of the LORD's offerings made by fire, a perpetual due.'
- 10 *And the son of an Israelitish woman, whose father was an Egyptian, went out among the children of Israel: and this Israelitish woman's son and a man of Israel strove together in the camp;* Now an Israelite woman's son, whose father was an Egyptian, went out among the children of Israel. And the Israelite woman's son and a man of Israel fought in the camp,

■ **NAME NOTE** Shelomith (SHEL-oh-mith) — "Peaceable" Mother of the man who blasphemed the Name and was stoned. Daughter of Dibri of the tribe of Dan. The only woman named in Leviticus. Dibri (DIB-rye) — "Eloquent, speaker" Father of Shelomith, of the tribe of Dan. Grandfather of the man executed for blasphemy.

- 11 *And the Israelitish woman's son blasphemed the name of the LORD, and cursed. And they brought him unto Moses: (and his mother's name was Shelomith, the daughter of Dibri, of the tribe of Dan:)* the Israelite woman's son blasphemed the Name, and cursed. Then they brought him to Moses. His mother's name was Shelomith, the daughter of Dibri, of the tribe of Dan.
- 12 *And they put him in ward, that the mind of the LORD might be shewed them.* they put Him in custody, till the will of the LORD should be clear to them.
- 13 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* Then the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 14 *Bring forth him that hath cursed without the camp; and let all that heard him lay their hands upon his head, and let all the congregation stone him.* 'Bring out of the camp the one who cursed, and let all who heard him lay their hands on His head, and let all the congregation stone Him.
- 15 *And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, Whosoever curseth his God shall bear his sin.* speak to the children of Israel, saying, Whoever curses his God shall bear His sin.

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| <p>16 <i>And he that blasphemeth the name of the LORD, he shall surely be put to death, and all the congregation shall certainly stone him: as well the stranger, as he that is born in the land, when he blasphemeth the name of the LORD, shall be put to death.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And he that killeth any man shall surely be put to death.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And he that killeth a beast shall make it good; beast for beast.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And if a man cause a blemish in his neighbour; as he hath done, so shall it be done to him;</i></p> <p>20 <i>Breach for breach, eye for eye, tooth for tooth: as he hath caused a blemish in a man, so shall it be done to him again.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And he that killeth a beast, he shall restore it: and he that killeth a man, he shall be put to death.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Ye shall have one manner of law, as well for the stranger, as for one of your own country: for I am the LORD your God.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And Moses spake to the children of Israel, that they should bring forth him that had cursed out of the camp, and stone him with stones. And the children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses.</i></p> | <p>Whoever blasphemes the name of the LORD shall surely be put to death. All the congregation shall stone Him. The sojourner as well as the native, when He blasphemes the Name, shall be put to death.</p> <p>Whoever takes a human life shall surely be put to death.</p> <p>Whoever takes an animal's life shall make it good, life for life.</p> <p>If anyone injures his neighbor, as he has done it shall be done to Him,</p> <p>fracture for fracture, eye for eye, tooth for tooth; whatever injury He has given a person shall be given to Him.</p> <p>Whoever kills an animal shall make it good, and whoever kills a person shall be put to death.</p> <p>You shall have the same rule for the sojourner and for the native, for I am the LORD Your God.'</p> <p>So Moses spoke to the children of Israel. They brought out of the camp the one who had cursed and stoned him with stones. Thus the children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Dan (DAN) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Eph 5:8-14; 2 Cor 4:6; Ex 27:20-21; John 8:12
- v4 — Ex 31:8
- v5 — Ex 25:30
- v6 — 1 Kgs 7:48
- v7 — Lev 2:2
- v8 — 2 Chr 2:4; Num 4:7
- v9 — Lev 8:31; Luke 6:4; Mark 2:26; Matt 12:4
- v14 — Deut 17:7
- v16 — Matt 12:31
- v17 — Gen 9:5-6; Deut 19:11-12
- v20 — Deut 19:21
- v22 — Ex 12:49; Num 15:15-16; Num 9:14

Chapter 25

The LORD commands the land to rest every seventh year as a Sabbath, and every fiftieth year to be a jubilee when all land returns to its original owner and Hebrew slaves go free. He provides for the redemption of property and persons, declaring that the land is His and the Israelites are His servants.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses in mount Sinai, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses on Mount Sinai, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye come into the land which I give you, then shall the land keep a sabbath unto the LORD.</i> | 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, When You come into the land that I give You, the land shall keep a Sabbath to the LORD. |
| 3 | <i>Six years thou shalt sow thy field, and six years thou shalt prune thy vineyard, and gather in the fruit thereof;</i> | For six years You shall sow Your field, and for six years You shall prune Your vineyard and gather in its fruits, |
| 4 | <i>But in the seventh year shall be a sabbath of rest unto the land, a sabbath for the LORD: thou shalt neither sow thy field, nor prune thy vineyard.</i> | but in the seventh year there shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest for the land, a Sabbath to the LORD. You shall not sow Your field or prune Your vineyard. |

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| <p>5 <i>That which groweth of its own accord of thy harvest thou shalt not reap, neither gather the grapes of thy vine undressed: for it is a year of rest unto the land.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And the sabbath of the land shall be meat for you; for thee, and for thy servant, and for thy maid, and for thy hired servant, and for thy stranger that sojourneth with thee,</i></p> <p>7 <i>And for thy cattle, and for the beast that are in thy land, shall all the increase thereof be meat.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And thou shalt number seven sabbaths of years unto thee, seven times seven years; and the space of the seven sabbaths of years shall be unto thee forty and nine years.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Then shalt thou cause the trumpet of the jubile to sound on the tenth day of the seventh month, in the day of atonement shall ye make the trumpet sound throughout all your land.</i></p> | <p>What grows of itself in Your harvest You shall not reap, and the grapes of Your undressed vine You shall not gather, for it is a year of solemn rest for the land.</p> <p>The Sabbath of the land shall provide food for You, for Yourself and for Your male and female slaves and for Your hired worker and the sojourner who lives with You,</p> <p>for Your cattle and for the wild animals that are in Your land: all its yield shall be for food.</p> <p>You shall count seven weeks of years, seven times seven years, so that the time of the seven weeks of years shall give You forty-nine years.</p> <p>Then You shall sound the loud trumpet on the tenth day of the seventh month. On the Day of Atonement You shall sound the trumpet throughout all Your land.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** *Jubile (JOO-bih-lee) — "Ram's horn (yobel), or shout of joy" The fiftieth year, proclaimed by the blowing of the shofar on the Day of Atonement. All land returned to its original family. All Israelite slaves freed. A picture of comprehensive restoration and liberty. The Liberty Bell inscription comes from Leviticus 25:10: 'Proclaim liberty throughout all the land.'*

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| <p>10 <i>And ye shall hallow the fiftieth year, and proclaim liberty throughout all the land unto all the inhabitants thereof: it shall be a jubile unto you; and ye shall return every man unto his possession, and ye shall return every man unto his family.</i></p> | <p>you shall consecrate the fiftieth year, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee for You, when each of You shall return to His property and each of You shall return to His clan.</p> |
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- 11 *A jubile shall that fiftieth year be unto you: ye shall not sow, neither reap that which groweth of itself in it, nor gather the grapes in it of thy vine undressed.* That fiftieth year shall be a jubilee for You; in it You shall neither sow nor reap what grows of itself nor gather the grapes from the undressed vines.
- 12 *For it is the jubile; it shall be holy unto you: ye shall eat the increase thereof out of the field.* For it is a jubilee. It shall be holy to You. You may eat the produce of the field.
- 13 *In the year of this jubile ye shall return every man unto his possession.* In this year of jubilee each of You shall return to His property.
- 14 *And if thou sell ought unto thy neighbour, or buyest ought of thy neighbour's hand, ye shall not oppress one another:* if You make a sale to Your neighbor or buy from Your neighbor, You shall not wrong one another.
- 15 *According to the number of years after the jubile thou shalt buy of thy neighbour, and according unto the number of years of the fruits he shall sell unto thee:* You shall pay Your neighbor according to the number of years after the jubilee. He shall sell to You according to the number of years for crops.
- 16 *According to the multitude of years thou shalt increase the price thereof, and according to the fewness of years thou shalt diminish the price of it: for according to the number of the years of the fruits doth he sell unto thee.* If the years are many, You shall increase the price, and if the years are few, You shall reduce the price, for it is the number of the crops that He is selling to You.
- 17 *Ye shall not therefore oppress one another; but thou shalt fear thy God: for I am the LORD your God.* You shall not wrong one another, but You shall fear Your God, for I am the LORD Your God.
- 18 *Wherefore ye shall do my statutes, and keep my judgments, and do them; and ye shall dwell in the land in safety.* Therefore You shall do my statutes and keep my rules and perform them, and then You will dwell in the land securely.

- 19 *And the land shall yield her fruit, and ye shall eat your fill, and dwell therein in safety.* The land will yield its fruit, and You will eat Your fill and dwell in it securely.
- 20 *And if ye shall say, What shall we eat the seventh year? behold, we shall not sow, nor gather in our increase:* if You say, What shall we eat in the seventh year, if we may not sow or gather in our crop?
- 21 *Then I will command my blessing upon you in the sixth year, and it shall bring forth fruit for three years.* I will command my blessing on You in the sixth year, so that it will produce a crop sufficient for three years.
- 22 *And ye shall sow the eighth year, and eat yet of old fruit until the ninth year; until her fruits come in ye shall eat of the old store.* When You sow in the eighth year, You will be eating some of the old crop; You shall eat the old until the ninth year, when its crop arrives.
- 23 *The land shall not be sold for ever: for the land is mine; for ye are strangers and sojourners with me.* The land shall not be sold in perpetuity, for the land is mine. For You are strangers and sojourners with me.
- 24 *And in all the land of your possession ye shall grant a redemption for the land.* in all the country You possess, You shall allow a redemption of the land.
- 25 *If thy brother be waxen poor, and hath sold away some of his possession, and if any of his kin come to redeem it, then shall he redeem that which his brother sold.* If Your brother becomes poor and sells part of His property, then His nearest redeemer shall come and redeem what His brother has sold.
- 26 *And if the man have none to redeem it, and himself be able to redeem it;* If a man has no one to redeem it and then himself becomes prosperous and finds sufficient means to redeem it,
- 27 *Then let him count the years of the sale thereof, and restore the overplus unto the man to whom he sold it; that he may return unto his possession.* let him calculate the years since he sold it and pay back the balance to the man to whom he sold it, and then return to his property.

- 28 *But if he be not able to restore it to him, then that which is sold shall remain in the hand of him that hath bought it until the year of jubile: and in the jubile it shall go out, and he shall return unto his possession.* But if he does not have sufficient means to recover it, then what he sold shall remain in the hand of the buyer until the year of jubilee. In the jubilee it shall be released. He shall return to his property.
- 29 *And if a man sell a dwelling house in a walled city, then he may redeem it within a whole year after it is sold; within a full year may he redeem it.* If a man sells a dwelling house in a walled city, he may redeem it within a year of its sale. For a full year he shall have the right of redemption.
- 30 *And if it be not redeemed within the space of a full year, then the house that is in the walled city shall be established for ever to him that bought it throughout his generations: it shall not go out in the jubile.* If it is not redeemed within a full year, then the house in the walled city shall belong in perpetuity to the buyer, throughout his generations; it shall not be released in the jubilee.
- 31 *But the houses of the villages which have no wall round about them shall be counted as the fields of the country: they may be redeemed, and they shall go out in the jubile.* But the houses of the villages that have no wall around them shall be classified with the fields of the land. They may be redeemed. They shall be released in the jubilee.
- 32 *Notwithstanding the cities of the Levites, and the houses of the cities of their possession, may the Levites redeem at any time.* As for the cities of the Levites, the Levites may redeem at any time the houses in the cities they possess.
- 33 *And if a man purchase of the Levites, then the house that was sold, and the city of his possession, shall go out in the year of jubile: for the houses of the cities of the Levites are their possession among the children of Israel.* if one of the Levites exercises his right of redemption, then the house that was sold in a city they possess shall be released in the jubilee. For the houses in the cities of the Levites are their possession among the children of Israel.
- 34 *But the field of the suburbs of their cities may not be sold; for it is their perpetual possession.* But the fields of pastureland belonging to their cities may not be sold, for that is their permanent possession.

- 35 *And if thy brother be waxen poor, and fallen in decay with thee; then thou shalt relieve him: yea, though he be a stranger, or a sojourner; that he may live with thee.* If your brother becomes poor and cannot maintain himself with you, you shall support him as though he were a stranger and a sojourner. He shall live with you.
- 36 *Take thou no usury of him, or increase: but fear thy God; that thy brother may live with thee.* Take no interest from him or profit, but fear your God, that your brother may live beside you.
- 37 *Thou shalt not give him thy money upon usury, nor lend him thy victuals for increase.* You shall not lend him your money at interest, nor give him your food for profit.
- 38 *I am the LORD your God, which brought you forth out of the land of Egypt, to give you the land of Canaan, and to be your God.* I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt to give You the land of Canaan, and to be Your God.
- 39 *And if thy brother that dwelleth by thee be waxen poor, and be sold unto thee; thou shalt not compel him to serve as a bondservant:* If Your brother becomes poor beside You and sells Himself to You, You shall not make Him serve as a slave.
- 40 *But as an hired servant, and as a sojourner, he shall be with thee, and shall serve thee unto the year of jubile:* He shall be with You as a hired worker and as a sojourner. He shall serve with You until the year of the jubilee.
- 41 *And then shall he depart from him, and his children with him, and shall return unto his own family, and unto the possession of his fathers shall he return.* Then He shall go out from You, He and His children with Him, and go back to His own clan and return to the possession of His fathers.
- 42 *For they are my servants, which I brought forth out of the land of Egypt: they shall not be sold as bondmen.* For they are my servants, whom I brought out of the land of Egypt; they shall not be sold as slaves.
- 43 *Thou shalt not rule over him with rigour; but shalt fear thy God.* You shall not rule over Him ruthlessly but shall fear Your God.

- 44 *Both thy bondmen, and thy bondmaids, which thou shalt have, shall be of the heathen that are round about you; of them shall ye buy bondmen and bondmaids.* As for Your male and female slaves whom You may have: You may buy male and female slaves from among the nations that are around you.
- 45 *Moreover of the children of the strangers that do sojourn among you, of them shall ye buy, and of their families that are with you, which they begat in your land: and they shall be your possession.* You may also buy from among the strangers who stay with You and their clans that are with You, who have been born in Your land. They may be Your property.
- 46 *And ye shall take them as an inheritance for your children after you, to inherit them for a possession; they shall be your bondmen for ever: but over your brethren the children of Israel, ye shall not rule one over another with rigour.* You may bequeath them to Your sons after You to inherit as a possession forever. You may make slaves of them, but over Your brothers the children of Israel You shall not rule, one over another ruthlessly.
- 47 *And if a sojourner or stranger wax rich by thee, and thy brother that dwelleth by him wax poor, and sell himself unto the stranger or sojourner by thee, or to the stock of the stranger's family:* If a stranger or sojourner with You becomes rich, and Your brother beside Him becomes poor and sells Himself to the stranger or sojourner with You or to a member of the stranger's clan,
- 48 *After that he is sold he may be redeemed again; one of his brethren may redeem him:* then after He is sold He may be redeemed. One of His brothers may redeem Him,
- 49 *Either his uncle, or his uncle's son, may redeem him, or any that is nigh of kin unto him of his family may redeem him; or if he be able, he may redeem himself.* or his uncle or his cousin may redeem Him, or a close relative from His clan may redeem Him. Or if He grows rich He may redeem Himself.

- 50 *And he shall reckon with him that bought him from the year that he was sold to him unto the year of jubile: and the price of his sale shall be according unto the number of years, according to the time of an hired servant shall it be with him.* He shall calculate with His buyer from the year when He sold Himself to Him until the year of jubilee, and the price of His sale shall vary with the number of years. The time He was with His owner shall be rated as the time of a hired worker.
- 51 *If there be yet many years behind, according unto them he shall give again the price of his redemption out of the money that he was bought for.* If there are still many years left, He shall pay proportionally for His redemption some of His sale price.
- 52 *And if there remain but few years unto the year of jubile, then he shall count with him, and according unto his years shall he give him again the price of his redemption.* If there remain but a few years until the year of jubilee, He shall calculate and pay for His redemption in proportion to His years of service.
- 53 *And as a yearly hired servant shall he be with him: and the other shall not rule with rigour over him in thy sight.* He shall treat Him as a worker hired year by year. He shall not rule ruthlessly over Him in Your sight.
- 54 *And if he be not redeemed in these years, then he shall go out in the year of jubile, both he, and his children with him.* if He is not redeemed by these means, then He and His children with Him shall be released in the year of jubilee.
- 55 *For unto me the children of Israel are servants; they are my servants whom I brought forth out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.* For it is to me that the children of Israel are servants. They are my servants whom I brought out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD Your God.'

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

vituals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Cross-References:

- v4 — Lev 25:20-23; 2 Chr 36:21
- v9 — Lev 23:24; Lev 23:27
- v10 — Jer 34:8; Isa 63:4; 1 Pet 2:16; Gal 5:13; Isa 61:1-3
- v14 — Lev 19:13; Lev 25:17
- v17 — Lev 19:32; Lev 19:14
- v18 — Jer 23:6; Deut 12:10; Prov 1:33
- v21 — Deut 28:8; Prov 10:22; 2 Cor 9:10; Ps 133:3; Deut 28:3
- v23 — 1 Pet 2:11; Ezek 48:14; Ps 24:1; 1 Chr 29:15; Ps 39:12
- v35 — Deut 15:7-8
- v36 — Ex 22:25; Deut 23:19-20
- v39 — Ex 21:2; 1 Kgs 9:22
- v42 — Lev 25:55; Rom 6:22

Chapter 26

The LORD promises blessings for obedience -- rain, abundant harvests, peace, and His presence among His people. He warns of escalating punishments for disobedience -- disease, defeat, famine, and exile -- but promises that if they confess their sin, He will remember His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

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| 1 | <i>Ye shall make you no idols nor graven image, neither rear you up a standing image, neither shall ye set up any image of stone in your land, to bow down unto it: for I am the LORD your God.</i> | 'You shall not make idols for yourselves or erect an image or pillar, and You shall not set up a figured stone in Your land to bow down to it, for I am the LORD Your God. |
| 2 | <i>Ye shall keep my sabbaths, and reverence my sanctuary: I am the LORD.</i> | You shall keep my Sabbaths and reverence my sanctuary: I am the LORD. |
| 3 | <i>If ye walk in my statutes, and keep my commandments, and do them;</i> | If You walk in my statutes and observe my commandments and do them, |
| 4 | <i>Then I will give you rain in due season, and the land shall yield her increase, and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit.</i> | then I will give You Your rains in their season, and the land shall yield its increase, and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit. |

- 5 *And your threshing shall reach unto the vintage, and the vintage shall reach unto the sowing time: and ye shall eat your bread to the full, and dwell in your land safely.* Your threshing shall last to the time of the grape harvest, and the grape harvest shall last to the time for sowing. And You shall eat Your bread to the full and dwell in Your land securely.
- 6 *And I will give peace in the land, and ye shall lie down, and none shall make you afraid: and I will rid evil beasts out of the land, neither shall the sword go through your land.* I will give peace in the land, and You shall lie down, and none shall make You afraid. And I will remove harmful beasts from the land, and the sword shall not go through Your land.
- 7 *And ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword.* You shall chase Your enemies. They shall fall before You by the sword.
- 8 *And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.* Five of You shall chase a hundred, and a hundred of You shall chase ten thousand, and Your enemies shall fall before You by the sword.
- 9 *For I will have respect unto you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, and establish my covenant with you.* I will turn to You and make You fruitful and multiply You and will confirm my covenant with You.
- 10 *And ye shall eat old store, and bring forth the old because of the new.* You shall eat old grain long kept, and You shall clear out the old to make way for the new.
- 11 *And I will set my tabernacle among you: and my soul shall not abhor you.* I will make my dwelling among You, and my soul shall not abhor You.
- 12 *And I will walk among you, and will be your God, and ye shall be my people.* I will walk among You and will be Your God, and You shall be my people.

- 13 *I am the LORD your God, which brought you forth out of the land of Egypt, that ye should not be their bondmen; and I have broken the bands of your yoke, and made you go upright.* I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, that You should not be their slaves. And I have broken the bars of Your yoke and made You walk upright.
- 14 *But if ye will not hearken unto me, and will not do all these commandments;* But if You will not listen to me and will not do all these commandments,
- 15 *And if ye shall despise my statutes, or if your soul abhor my judgments, so that ye will not do all my commandments, but that ye break my covenant:* if You spurn my statutes, and if Your soul abhors my rules, so that You will not do all my commandments, but break my covenant,
- 16 *I also will do this unto you; I will even appoint over you terror, consumption, and the burning ague, that shall consume the eyes, and cause sorrow of heart: and ye shall sow your seed in vain, for your enemies shall eat it.* then I will do this to You: I will visit You with panic, with wasting disease and fever that consume the eyes and make the heart ache. And You shall sow Your seed in vain, for Your enemies shall eat it.
- 17 *And I will set my face against you, and ye shall be slain before your enemies: they that hate you shall reign over you; and ye shall flee when none pursueth you.* I will set my face against You, and You shall be struck down before Your enemies. Those who hate You shall rule over You, and You shall flee when none pursues You.
- 18 *And if ye will not yet for all this hearken unto me, then I will punish you seven times more for your sins.* if in spite of this You will not listen to me, then I will discipline You again sevenfold for Your sins,
- 19 *And I will break the pride of your power; and I will make your heaven as iron, and your earth as brass:* I will break the pride of Your power. I will make Your heavens like iron and Your earth like bronze.
- 20 *And your strength shall be spent in vain: for your land shall not yield her increase, neither shall the trees of the land yield their fruits.* your strength shall be spent in vain, for Your land shall not yield its increase, and the trees of the land shall not yield their fruit.

- 21 *And if ye walk contrary unto me, and will not hearken unto me; I will bring seven times more plagues upon you according to your sins.* Then if You walk contrary to me and will not listen to me, I will continue striking You, sevenfold for Your sins.
- 22 *I will also send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children, and destroy your cattle, and make you few in number; and your high ways shall be desolate.* I will let loose the wild beasts against You, which shall bereave You of Your children and destroy Your livestock and make You few in number, so that Your roads shall be deserted.
- 23 *And if ye will not be reformed by me by these things, but will walk contrary unto me;* if by this discipline You are not turned to me but walk contrary to me,
- 24 *Then will I also walk contrary unto you, and will punish you yet seven times for your sins.* then I also will walk contrary to You. I myself will strike You sevenfold for Your sins.
- 25 *And I will bring a sword upon you, that shall avenge the quarrel of my covenant: and when ye are gathered together within your cities, I will send the pestilence among you; and ye shall be delivered into the hand of the enemy.* I will bring a sword upon You, that shall execute vengeance for the covenant. And if You gather within Your cities, I will send pestilence among You, and You shall be delivered into the hand of the enemy.
- 26 *And when I have broken the staff of your bread, ten women shall bake your bread in one oven, and they shall deliver you your bread again by weight: and ye shall eat, and not be satisfied.* When I break Your supply of bread, ten women shall bake Your bread in a single oven and shall dole out Your bread again by weight, and You shall eat and not be satisfied.
- 27 *And if ye will not for all this hearken unto me, but walk contrary unto me;* But if in spite of this You will not listen to me, but walk contrary to me,
- 28 *Then I will walk contrary unto you also in fury; and I, even I, will chastise you seven times for your sins.* then I will walk contrary to You in fury. I myself will discipline You sevenfold for Your sins.

- 29 *And ye shall eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters shall ye eat.* You shall eat the flesh of Your sons, and You shall eat the flesh of Your daughters.
- 30 *And I will destroy your high places, and cut down your images, and cast your carcasses upon the carcasses of your idols, and my soul shall abhor you.* I will destroy Your high places and cut down Your incense altars and cast Your dead bodies upon the dead bodies of Your idols, and my soul will abhor You.
- 31 *And I will make your cities waste, and bring your sanctuaries unto desolation, and I will not smell the savour of your sweet odours.* I will lay Your cities waste and will make Your sanctuaries desolate. I will not smell Your sweet savours.
- 32 *And I will bring the land into desolation: and your enemies which dwell therein shall be astonished at it.* I myself will devastate the land, so that Your enemies who settle in it shall be appalled at it.
- 33 *And I will scatter you among the heathen, and will draw out a sword after you: and your land shall be desolate, and your cities waste.* I will scatter You among the nations. I will unsheathe the sword after you, and Your land shall be a desolation, and Your cities shall be a waste.
- 34 *Then shall the land enjoy her sabbaths, as long as it lieth desolate, and ye be in your enemies' land; even then shall the land rest, and enjoy her sabbaths.* Then the land shall enjoy its Sabbaths as long as it lies desolate, while You are in Your enemies' land; then the land shall rest, and enjoy its Sabbaths.
- 35 *As long as it lieth desolate it shall rest; because it did not rest in your sabbaths, when ye dwelt upon it.* As long as it lies desolate it shall have rest, the rest that it did not have on Your Sabbaths when You were dwelling in it.
- 36 *And upon them that are left alive of you I will send a faintness into their hearts in the lands of their enemies; and the sound of a shaken leaf shall chase them; and they shall flee, as fleeing from a sword; and they shall fall when none pursueth.* as for those of You who are left, I will send faintness into their hearts in the lands of their enemies. The sound of a driven leaf shall put them to flight. They shall flee as one flees from the sword. They shall fall when none pursues.

- 37 *And they shall fall one upon another, as it were before a sword, when none pursueth; and ye shall have no power to stand before your enemies.* They shall stumble over one another, as if to escape a sword, though none pursues. And You shall have no power to stand before Your enemies.
- 38 *And ye shall perish among the heathen, and the land of your enemies shall eat you up.* you shall perish among the nations, and the land of your enemies shall eat You up.
- 39 *And they that are left of you shall pine away in their iniquity in your enemies' lands; and also in the iniquities of their fathers shall they pine away with them.* those of You who are left shall rot away in Your enemies' lands because of their iniquity, and also because of the iniquities of their fathers they shall rot away like them.
- 40 *If they shall confess their iniquity, and the iniquity of their fathers, with their trespass which they trespassed against me, and that also they have walked contrary unto me;* But if they confess their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers in their treachery that they committed against me, and also in walking contrary to me,
- 41 *And that I also have walked contrary unto them, and have brought them into the land of their enemies; if then their uncircumcised hearts be humbled, and they then accept of the punishment of their iniquity:* so that I walked contrary to them and brought them into the land of their enemies — if then their uncircumcised heart is humbled and they make amends for their iniquity,
- 42 *Then will I remember my covenant with Jacob, and also my covenant with Isaac, and also my covenant with Abraham will I remember; and I will remember the land.* then I will remember my covenant with Jacob. I will remember my covenant with Isaac and my covenant with Abraham. I will remember the land.

- 43 *The land also shall be left of them, and shall enjoy her sabbaths, while she lieth desolate without them: and they shall accept of the punishment of their iniquity: because, even because they despised my judgments, and because their soul abhorred my statutes.* But the land shall be abandoned by them and enjoy its Sabbaths while it lies desolate without them. They shall make amends for their iniquity, because they spurned my rules and their soul abhorred my statutes.
- 44 *And yet for all that, when they be in the land of their enemies, I will not cast them away, neither will I abhor them, to destroy them utterly, and to break my covenant with them: for I am the LORD their God.* Yet for all that, when they are in the land of their enemies, I will not spurn them, neither will I abhor them so as to destroy them utterly and break my covenant with them, for I am the LORD their God.
- 45 *But I will for their sakes remember the covenant of their ancestors, whom I brought forth out of the land of Egypt in the sight of the heathen, that I might be their God: I am the LORD.* But I will for their sake remember the covenant with their forefathers, whom I brought out of the land of Egypt in the sight of the nations, that I might be their God: I am the LORD.'
- 46 *These are the statutes and judgments and laws, which the LORD made between him and the children of Israel in mount Sinai by the hand of Moses.* These are the statutes and rules and laws that the LORD made between Himself and the children of Israel through Moses on Mount Sinai.

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Lev 19:4; Ex 23:24; Deut 27:15; Num 33:52; Ex 20:4-5
v3 — Isa 1:19; Deut 28:1-14; Deut 11:13-15; Isa 48:18-19; Ps 81:12-16
v5 — Amos 9:13; Joel 2:26; Joel 2:19; Lev 25:18-19
v6 — Isa 35:9; Zeph 3:13; Ps 147:14; Jer 30:10; Hag 2:9
v8 — Josh 23:10; Deut 28:7; Deut 32:30; Num 14:9; 1 Chr 11:20
v9 — Gen 17:6-7; Neh 9:23; Ezek 16:62; Ps 107:38; Isa 55:3

- v11** — Ex 25:8; Rev 21:3; Ps 132:13-14; Ex 29:45; Eph 2:22
- v12** — 2 Cor 6:16; Jer 30:22; Jer 7:23; Ex 6:7; Deut 23:14
- v13** — Ezek 34:27; Ex 20:2; Lev 25:38; Ps 116:16
- v16** — Job 31:8; Jer 5:17; Mic 6:15
- v33** — Deut 4:27; Zech 7:14; Ezek 20:23; Deut 28:64-66
- v40** — Prov 28:13; Neh 9:2-5; 1 John 1:8-10; Hos 5:15-6:2

Chapter 27

The LORD gives laws for the valuation of persons, animals, houses, and fields dedicated to Him by special vows. Valuations are set according to age and sex, and anything devoted may be redeemed by adding a fifth to its value; every tithe of the land and herds is holy to the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When a man shall make a singular vow, the persons shall be for the LORD by thy estimation.</i> | 'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, If anyone makes a special vow to the LORD involving the valuation of persons, |
| 3 | <i>And thy estimation shall be of the male from twenty years old even unto sixty years old, even thy estimation shall be fifty shekels of silver, after the shekel of the sanctuary.</i> | then the valuation of a male from twenty years old up to sixty years old shall be fifty shekels of silver, according to the shekel of the sanctuary. |
| 4 | <i>And if it be a female, then thy estimation shall be thirty shekels.</i> | If the person is a female, the valuation shall be thirty shekels. |
| 5 | <i>And if it be from five years old even unto twenty years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male twenty shekels, and for the female ten shekels.</i> | If the person is from five to twenty years of age, the valuation shall be for a male twenty shekels, and for a female ten shekels. |

- 6 *And if it be from a month old even unto five years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male five shekels of silver, and for the female thy estimation shall be three shekels of silver.* If the person is from a month old up to five years of age, the valuation shall be for a male five shekels of silver, and for a female the valuation shall be three shekels of silver.
- 7 *And if it be from sixty years old and above; if it be a male, then thy estimation shall be fifteen shekels, and for the female ten shekels.* if the person is sixty years old or over, then the valuation for a male shall be fifteen shekels, and for a female ten shekels.
- 8 *But if he be poorer than thy estimation, then he shall present himself before the priest, and the priest shall value him; according to his ability that vowed shall the priest value him.* if someone is too poor to pay the valuation, then he shall be made to stand before the priest, and the priest shall value him; the priest shall value him according to what the vowing person can afford.
- 9 *And if it be a beast, whereof men bring an offering unto the LORD, all that any man giveth of such unto the LORD shall be holy.* If the vow is an animal that may be offered as an offering to the LORD, all of it that He gives to the LORD is holy.
- 10 *He shall not alter it, nor change it, a good for a bad, or a bad for a good: and if he shall at all change beast for beast, then it and the exchange thereof shall be holy.* He shall not exchange it or make a substitute for it, good for bad, or bad for good. If He does in fact substitute one animal for another, then both it and the substitute shall be holy.
- 11 *And if it be any unclean beast, of which they do not offer a sacrifice unto the LORD, then he shall present the beast before the priest:* if it is any unclean animal that may not be offered as an offering to the LORD, then He shall stand the animal before the priest,
- 12 *And the priest shall value it, whether it be good or bad: as thou valuest it, who art the priest, so shall it be.* the priest shall value it as either good or bad; as the priest values it, so it shall be.
- 13 *But if he will at all redeem it, then he shall add a fifth part thereof unto thy estimation.* But if he wishes to redeem it, he shall add a fifth to the valuation.

- 14 *And when a man shall sanctify his house to be holy unto the LORD, then the priest shall estimate it, whether it be good or bad: as the priest shall estimate it, so shall it stand.* When a man dedicates his house as a holy gift to the LORD, the priest shall value it as either good or bad; as the priest values it, so it shall stand.
- 15 *And if he that sanctified it will redeem his house, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of thy estimation unto it, and it shall be his.* if the donor wishes to redeem His house, He shall add a fifth to the valuation price. It shall be His.
- 16 *And if a man shall sanctify unto the LORD some part of a field of his possession, then thy estimation shall be according to the seed thereof: an homer of barley seed shall be valued at fifty shekels of silver.* If a man dedicates to the LORD part of the land that is His possession, then the valuation shall be in proportion to its seed. A homer of barley seed shall be valued at fifty shekels of silver.
- 17 *If he sanctify his field from the year of jubile, according to thy estimation it shall stand.* If He dedicates His field from the year of jubilee, the valuation shall stand.
- 18 *But if he sanctify his field after the jubile, then the priest shall reckon unto him the money according to the years that remain, even unto the year of the jubile, and it shall be abated from thy estimation.* But if he dedicates his field after the jubilee, then the priest shall calculate the price according to the years that remain until the year of jubilee, and a deduction shall be made from the valuation.
- 19 *And if he that sanctified the field will in any wise redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of thy estimation unto it, and it shall be assured to him.* if he who dedicates the field wishes to redeem it, then he shall add a fifth to its valuation price. It shall remain his.
- 20 *And if he will not redeem the field, or if he have sold the field to another man, it shall not be redeemed any more.* But if he does not wish to redeem the field, or if he has sold the field to another man, it shall not be redeemed anymore.

- 21 *But the field, when it goeth out in the jubile, shall be holy unto the LORD, as a field devoted; the possession thereof shall be the priest's.* But the field, when it is released in the jubilee, shall be a holy gift to the LORD, like a field that has been devoted. The priest shall be in possession of it.
- 22 *And if a man sanctify unto the LORD a field which he hath bought, which is not of the fields of his possession;* If He dedicates to the LORD a field that He has bought, which is not a part of His possession,
- 23 *Then the priest shall reckon unto him the worth of thy estimation, even unto the year of the jubile: and he shall give thine estimation in that day, as a holy thing unto the LORD.* then the priest shall calculate the amount of the valuation for it up to the year of jubilee, and the man shall give the valuation on that day as a holy gift to the LORD.
- 24 *In the year of the jubile the field shall return unto him of whom it was bought, even to him to whom the possession of the land did belong.* In the year of jubilee the field shall return to Him from whom it was bought, to whom the land belongs as a possession.
- 25 *And all thy estimations shall be according to the shekel of the sanctuary: twenty gerahs shall be the shekel.* Every valuation shall be according to the shekel of the sanctuary: twenty gerahs shall make a shekel.
- 26 *Only the firstling of the beasts, which should be the LORD's firstling, no man shall sanctify it; whether it be ox, or sheep: it is the LORD's.* But a firstborn of animals, which as a firstborn belongs to the LORD, no man may dedicate; whether ox or sheep, it is the LORD's.
- 27 *And if it be of an unclean beast, then he shall redeem it according to thine estimation, and shall add a fifth part of it thereto: or if it be not redeemed, then it shall be sold according to thy estimation.* if it is an unclean animal, then He shall buy it back at the valuation, and add a fifth to it; or, if it is not redeemed, it shall be sold at the valuation.

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| <p>28 <i>Notwithstanding no devoted thing, that a man shall devote unto the LORD of all that he hath, both of man and beast, and of the field of his possession, shall be sold or redeemed: every devoted thing is most holy unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>29 <i>None devoted, which shall be devoted of men, shall be redeemed; but shall surely be put to death.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And all the tithe of the land, whether of the seed of the land, or of the fruit of the tree, is the LORD's: it is holy unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And if a man will at all redeem ought of his tithes, he shall add thereto the fifth part thereof.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And concerning the tithe of the herd, or of the flock, even of whatsoever passeth under the rod, the tenth shall be holy unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>33 <i>He shall not search whether it be good or bad, neither shall he change it: and if he change it at all, then both it and the change thereof shall be holy; it shall not be redeemed.</i></p> <p>34 <i>These are the commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses for the children of Israel in mount Sinai.</i></p> | <p>But no devoted thing that a man devotes to the LORD, of anything that He has, whether man or beast, or of His inherited field, shall be sold or redeemed; every devoted thing is most holy to the LORD.</p> <p>No one devoted, who is to be devoted for destruction from mankind, shall be ransomed; He shall surely be put to death.</p> <p>Every tithe of the land, whether of the seed of the land or of the fruit of the trees, is the LORD's; it is holy to the LORD.</p> <p>If a man wishes to redeem some of his tithe, he shall add a fifth to it.</p> <p>every tithe of herds and flocks, every tenth animal of all that pass under the herdsman's staff, shall be holy to the LORD.</p> <p>One shall not differentiate between good or bad, neither shall He make a substitute for it. If He does substitute for it, then both it and the substitute shall be holy; it shall not be redeemed.'</p> <p>These are the commandments that the LORD commanded Moses for the children of Israel on Mount Sinai.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Sinai (SY-ny) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

v3 — Ex 30:13

v21 — Ezek 44:29; Num 18:14

v25 — Ex 30:13

v26 — Ex 13:2

v28 — Josh 6:17-19; Ex 22:20; Lev 27:21; Deut 20:16-17

v29 — 1 Sam 15:18-23

v30 — Matt 23:23; Neh 10:37-38; Gen 28:22; Neh 13:12; Gen 14:20

v32 — Jer 33:13; Ezek 20:37

v34 — Lev 26:46

Numbers

Author: Moses — Numbers records events from Moses's own lifetime and he is named as the author of specific sections within the book (Num 33:2).

Date written: c. 1445–1405 BC, during the forty years in the wilderness.

Written to: The nation of Israel in the wilderness, and the second generation preparing to enter Canaan.

Setting: Israel has been at Sinai receiving the law. Numbers opens with a military census, then follows forty years of wilderness wandering — triggered by the nation's refusal to trust God and enter Canaan at Kadesh-barnea.

Where this sits historically: c. 1446–1406 BC — the forty wilderness years between Egypt's 18th dynasty (Amenhotep II) and the eve of Canaan's conquest under Amenhotep III.

Contemporaries: Egypt's Amenhotep II, Thutmose IV, and the early reign of Amenhotep III. Edom, Moab, and Midian are the surrounding nations. Moses writes Exodus, Leviticus, and Deuteronomy alongside.

Big themes:

- Unbelief and its cost — ten of twelve spies give a faithless report; the entire generation is condemned to die in the wilderness as a consequence
- Murmuring — the people complain about food, water, leadership, and the journey itself; God's patience is tested repeatedly and His discipline is real
- The holiness of God — Nadab and Abihu, Korah's rebellion, and Moses's striking the rock all illustrate that God's holiness cannot be treated casually
- The second generation — the book ends with a new census of a new generation, ready to try again where their fathers failed
- Prophecy — Balaam's oracles (chs. 22–24) are among the most remarkable messianic prophecies in the OT, spoken by a pagan prophet against his own intentions

Key passages: Num 6:24–26; 14:18; 21:9; 23:19; 24:17

How it fits: Numbers is the wilderness years — the painful gap between redemption (Exodus) and inheritance (Joshua). Paul uses the wilderness generation as a warning to the church (1 Cor 10:1–11). The bronze serpent lifted in the wilderness becomes Christ's own illustration of His crucifixion (John 3:14).

Chapter 1

The LORD commands Moses to take a census of all men twenty years old and older who are able to go to war, tribe by tribe. The total count of Israel's fighting men is 603,550; the Levites are excluded from the military census and assigned to care for the tabernacle.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the tabernacle of the congregation, on the first day of the second month, in the second year after they were come out of the land of Egypt, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the tent of meeting, on the first day of the second month, in the second year after they had come out of the land of Egypt, saying, |
| 2 <i>Take ye the sum of all the congregation of the children of Israel, after their families, by the house of their fathers, with the number of their names, every male by their polls;</i> | "Take a census of all the congregation of the children of Israel, by clans and ancestral houses, according to the number of names, every male, head by head. |
| 3 <i>From twenty years old and upward, all that are able to go forth to war in Israel: thou and Aaron shall number them by their armies.</i> | From twenty years old and upward, all in Israel who are able to go to war, you and Aaron shall list them, company by company. |
| 4 <i>And with you there shall be a man of every tribe; every one head of the house of his fathers.</i> | there shall be with you a man from each tribe, each man being the head of the house of his fathers. |

■ **NAME NOTE** Elizur (EL-ih-zur) — "God is a rock" Chief of the tribe of Reuben appointed to assist Moses in the first census. Shedeur (SHED-ee-ur) — "Shedder of light" Father of Elizur, the leader of Reuben.

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| 5 <i>And these are the names of the men that shall stand with you: of the tribe of Reuben; Elizur the son of Shedeur.</i> | these are the names of the men who shall assist you. From Reuben, Elizur the son of Shedeur; |
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■ **NAME NOTE** Shelumiel (sheh-LOO-mee-el) — "Peace of God" Chief of the tribe of Simeon for the census. Zurishaddai (zur-ih-SHAD-eye) — "My rock is the Almighty" Father of Shelumiel, leader of Simeon.

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| 6 <i>Of Simeon; Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.</i> | from Simeon, Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai; |
| 7 <i>Of Judah; Nahshon the son of Amminadab.</i> | from Judah, Nahshon the son of Amminadab; |

■ **NAME NOTE** Nethanel (NETH-uh-nel) — "God has given" Chief of the tribe of Issachar for the census. Zuar (ZOO-ar) — "Small" Father of Nethanel, leader of Issachar.

- 8 *Of Issachar; Nethanel the son of Zuar.* from Issachar, Nethanel the son of Zuar;

■ **NAME NOTE** Eliab (ee-LY-ab) — "God is father" Chief of the tribe of Zebulun for the census. Helon (HEE-lon) — "Strong, powerful" Father of Eliab, leader of Zebulun.

- 9 *Of Zebulun; Eliab the son of Helon.* from Zebulun, Eliab the son of Helon;

■ **NAME NOTE** Elishama (ee-LISH-uh-muh) — "God has heard" Chief of the tribe of Ephraim for the census. Ammihud (AM-ih-hud) — "My kinsman is glorious" Father of Elishama, leader of Ephraim. Gamaliel (guh-MAY-lee-el) — "God is my reward" Chief of the tribe of Manasseh for the census. The same name was later carried by the famous rabbi who taught Paul. Pedahzur (PED-ah-zur) — "The Rock has redeemed" Father of Gamaliel, leader of Manasseh.

- 10 *Of the children of Joseph: of Ephraim; Elishama the son of Ammihud; of Manasseh; Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.* from the children of Joseph: from Ephraim, Elishama the son of Ammihud; from Manasseh, Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur;

■ **NAME NOTE** Abidan (AB-ih-dan) — "My father has judged" Chief of the tribe of Benjamin for the census. Gideoni (gid-ee-O-nye) — "Feller, hewer" Father of Abidan, leader of Benjamin.

- 11 *Of Benjamin; Abidan the son of Gideoni.* from Benjamin, Abidan the son of Gideoni;

■ **NAME NOTE** Ahiezer (ay-hee-EE-zer) — "My brother is help" Chief of the tribe of Dan for the census. Ammishaddai (am-ih-SHAD-eye) — "My kinsman is the Almighty" Father of Ahiezer, leader of Dan.

- 12 *Of Dan; Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.* from Dan, Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai;

■ **NAME NOTE** Pagiel (PAY-jee-el) — "Event of God" Chief of the tribe of Asher for the census. Ocran (OK-ran) — "Troubled" Father of Pagiel, leader of Asher.

- 13 *Of Asher; Pagiel the son of Ocran.* from Asher, Pagiel the son of Ocran;

■ **NAME NOTE** Eliasaph (ee-LY-uh-saf) — "God has added" Chief of the tribe of Gad for the census. Deuel (DEE-yoo-el) — "Known of God" Father of Eliasaph, leader of Gad.

- 14 *Of Gad; Eliasaph the son of Deuel.* from Gad, Eliasaph the son of Deuel;

■ **NAME NOTE** Ahira (uh-HY-rah) — "My brother is evil (or: brother of Ra)" Chief of the tribe of Naphtali for the census. Enan (EE-nan) — "Having eyes, fountains" Father of Ahira, leader of Naphtali.

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| 15 | <i>Of Naphtali; Ahira the son of Enan.</i> | from Naphtali, Ahira the son of Enan. |
| 16 | <i>These were the renowned of the congregation, princes of the tribes of their fathers, heads of thousands in Israel.</i> | These were the ones chosen from the congregation, the chiefs of their ancestral tribes, the heads of the clans of Israel. |
| 17 | <i>And Moses and Aaron took these men which are expressed by their names:</i> | Moses and Aaron took these men who had been named, |
| 18 | <i>And they assembled all the congregation together on the first day of the second month, and they declared their pedigrees after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, by their polls.</i> | on the first day of the second month they assembled the whole congregation, who registered themselves by clans, by ancestral houses, according to the number of names from twenty years old and upward, head by head. |
| 19 | <i>As the LORD commanded Moses, so he numbered them in the wilderness of Sinai.</i> | As the LORD commanded Moses, so he listed them in the wilderness of Sinai. |
| 20 | <i>And the children of Reuben, Israel's eldest son, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, by their polls, every male from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;</i> | The people of Reuben, Israel's firstborn, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, head by head, every male from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war: |
| 21 | <i>Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Reuben, were forty and six thousand and five hundred.</i> | those listed of the tribe of Reuben were 46,500. |

- 22 *Of the children of Simeon, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, those that were numbered of them, according to the number of the names, by their polls, every male from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Simeon, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, those of them who were listed, according to the number of names, head by head, every male from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 23 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Simeon, were fifty and nine thousand and three hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Simeon were 59,300.
- 24 *Of the children of Gad, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Gad, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 25 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Gad, were forty and five thousand six hundred and fifty.* those listed of the tribe of Gad were 45,650.
- 26 *Of the children of Judah, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Judah, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 27 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Judah, were threescore and fourteen thousand and six hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Judah were 74,600.

- 28 *Of the children of Issachar, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Issachar, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 29 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Issachar, were fifty and four thousand and four hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Issachar were 54,400.
- 30 *Of the children of Zebulun, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Zebulun, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 31 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Zebulun, were fifty and seven thousand and four hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Zebulun were 57,400.
- 32 *Of the children of Joseph, namely, of the children of Ephraim, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Joseph, namely the people of Ephraim, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 33 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Ephraim, were forty thousand and five hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Ephraim were 40,500.
- 34 *Of the children of Manasseh, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Manasseh, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:

- 35 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Manasseh, were thirty and two thousand and two hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Manasseh were 32,200.
- 36 *Of the children of Benjamin, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Benjamin, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 37 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Benjamin, were thirty and five thousand and four hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Benjamin were 35,400.
- 38 *Of the children of Dan, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Dan, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 39 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Dan, were threescore and two thousand and seven hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Dan were 62,700.
- 40 *Of the children of Asher, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Asher, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 41 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Asher, were forty and one thousand and five hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Asher were 41,500.

- 42 *Of the children of Naphtali, throughout their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;* The people of Naphtali, their generations, by their clans, by their ancestral houses, according to the number of names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go to war:
- 43 *Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Naphtali, were fifty and three thousand and four hundred.* those listed of the tribe of Naphtali were 53,400.
- 44 *These are those that were numbered, which Moses and Aaron numbered, and the princes of Israel, being twelve men: each one was for the house of his fathers.* These are those who were listed, whom Moses and Aaron listed with the help of the chiefs of Israel, twelve men, each representing his ancestral house.
- 45 *So were all those that were numbered of the children of Israel, by the house of their fathers, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war in Israel;* So all those listed of the children of Israel, by their ancestral houses, from twenty years old and upward, every man able to go to war in Israel —
- 46 *Even all they that were numbered were six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty.* all those listed were 603,550.
- 47 *But the Levites after the tribe of their fathers were not numbered among them.* But the Levites were not listed along with them by their ancestral tribe.
- 48 *For the LORD had spoken unto Moses, saying,* For the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 49 *Only thou shalt not number the tribe of Levi, neither take the sum of them among the children of Israel:* 'Only the tribe of Levi You shall not list, and You shall not take a census of them among the children of Israel.

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| 50 | <i>But thou shalt appoint the Levites over the tabernacle of testimony, and over all the vessels thereof, and over all things that belong to it: they shall bear the tabernacle, and all the vessels thereof; and they shall minister unto it, and shall encamp round about the tabernacle.</i> | But appoint the Levites over the tabernacle of the testimony, and over all its furnishings, and over all that belongs to it. They shall carry the tabernacle and all its furnishings. They shall take care of it and shall camp around the tabernacle. |
| 51 | <i>And when the tabernacle setteth forward, the Levites shall take it down: and when the tabernacle is to be pitched, the Levites shall set it up: and the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.</i> | When the tabernacle is to set out, the Levites shall take it down, and when the tabernacle is to be pitched, the Levites shall set it up. And if any outsider comes near, He shall be put to death. |
| 52 | <i>And the children of Israel shall pitch their tents, every man by his own camp, and every man by his own standard, throughout their hosts.</i> | The children of Israel shall pitch their tents by their companies, every man in his own camp and every man by his own standard. |
| 53 | <i>But the Levites shall pitch round about the tabernacle of testimony, that there be no wrath upon the congregation of the children of Israel: and the Levites shall keep the charge of the tabernacle of testimony.</i> | But the Levites shall camp around the tabernacle of the testimony, so that there may be no wrath on the congregation of the children of Israel. And the Levites shall keep guard over the tabernacle of the testimony.' |
| 54 | <i>And the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did they.</i> | Thus the children of Israel did; according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so they did. |

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

- Benjamin** (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'
- Dan** (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'
- Gad** (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'
- Issachar** (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ex 30:12; Ex 38:26
- v3 — Ex 30:14
- v16 — Ex 18:25; Ex 18:21; Num 7:2
- v18 — Ezra 2:59; Heb 7:3; Neh 7:61
- v46 — Ex 12:37; Ex 38:26; Num 26:51
- v47 — Num 2:33
- v50 — Ex 38:21
- v51 — Num 3:38
- v52 — Num 2:2
- v53 — Num 16:46

Chapter 2

The LORD arranges the twelve tribes into four camps of three tribes each around the tabernacle, each under its own standard. Judah's camp is on the east, Reuben's on the south, Ephraim's on the west, and Dan's on the north, with the Levites camped in the middle.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Every man of the children of Israel shall pitch by his own standard, with the ensign of their father's house: far off about the tabernacle of the congregation shall they pitch.</i> | 'The children of Israel shall camp each by His own standard, with the banners of their fathers' houses. They shall camp facing the tent of meeting on every side. |
| 3 | <i>And on the east side toward the rising of the sun shall they of the standard of the camp of Judah pitch throughout their armies: and Nahshon the son of Amminadab shall be captain of the children of Judah.</i> | Those to camp on the east side toward the sunrise shall be of the standard of the camp of Judah by their companies, the chief of the people of Judah being Nahshon the son of Amminadab. |

- 4 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were threescore and fourteen thousand and six hundred.* His company as listed being 74,600.
- 5 *And those that do pitch next unto him shall be the tribe of Issachar: and Nethanel the son of Zuar shall be captain of the children of Issachar.* those to camp next to Him shall be the tribe of Issachar, the chief of the people of Issachar being Nethanel the son of Zuar,
- 6 *And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were fifty and four thousand and four hundred.* his company as listed being 54,400.
- 7 *Then the tribe of Zebulun: and Eliab the son of Helon shall be captain of the children of Zebulun.* Then the tribe of Zebulun, the chief of the people of Zebulun being Eliab the son of Helon,
- 8 *And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were fifty and seven thousand and four hundred.* his company as listed being 57,400.
- 9 *All that were numbered in the camp of Judah were an hundred thousand and fourscore thousand and six thousand and four hundred, throughout their armies. These shall first set forth.* The whole number of the camp of Judah, by their companies, is 186,400. They shall set out first on the march.
- 10 *On the south side shall be the standard of the camp of Reuben according to their armies: and the captain of the children of Reuben shall be Elizur the son of Shedeur.* On the south side shall be the standard of the camp of Reuben by their companies, the chief of the people of Reuben being Elizur the son of Shedeur.
- 11 *And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were forty and six thousand and five hundred.* His company as listed being 46,500.
- 12 *And those which pitch by him shall be the tribe of Simeon: and the captain of the children of Simeon shall be Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.* those to camp next to Him shall be the tribe of Simeon, the chief of the people of Simeon being Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai,

- 13 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were fifty and nine thousand and three hundred.* his company as listed being 59,300.
- 14 *Then the tribe of Gad: and the captain of the sons of Gad shall be Eliasaph the son of Reuel.* Then the tribe of Gad, the chief of the people of Gad being Eliasaph the son of Reuel,
- 15 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty and five thousand and six hundred and fifty.* his company as listed being 45,650.
- 16 *All that were numbered in the camp of Reuben were an hundred thousand and fifty and one thousand and four hundred and fifty, throughout their armies. And they shall set forth in the second rank.* The whole number of the camp of Reuben, by their companies, is 151,450. They shall set out second.
- 17 *Then the tabernacle of the congregation shall set forward with the camp of the Levites in the midst of the camp: as they encamp, so shall they set forward, every man in his place by their standards.* Then the tent of meeting shall set out, with the camp of the Levites in the middle of the camps; as they camp, so shall they set out, each in position, standard by standard.
- 18 *On the west side shall be the standard of the camp of Ephraim according to their armies: and the captain of the children of Ephraim shall be Elishama the son of Ammihud.* On the west side shall be the standard of the camp of Ephraim by their companies, the chief of the people of Ephraim being Elishama the son of Ammihud.
- 19 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty thousand and five hundred.* His company as listed being 40,500.
- 20 *And by him shall be the tribe of Manasseh: and the captain of the children of Manasseh shall be Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.* next to him shall be the tribe of Manasseh, the chief of the people of Manasseh being Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur,

- 21 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were thirty and two thousand and two hundred.* his company as listed being 32,200.
- 22 *Then the tribe of Benjamin: and the captain of the sons of Benjamin shall be Abidan the son of Gideoni.* Then the tribe of Benjamin, the chief of the people of Benjamin being Abidan the son of Gideoni,
- 23 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were thirty and five thousand and four hundred.* his company as listed being 35,400.
- 24 *All that were numbered of the camp of Ephraim were an hundred thousand and eight thousand and an hundred, throughout their armies. And they shall go forward in the third rank.* The whole number of the camp of Ephraim, by their companies, is 108,100. They shall set out third on the march.
- 25 *The standard of the camp of Dan shall be on the north side by their armies: and the captain of the children of Dan shall be Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.* On the north side shall be the standard of the camp of Dan by their companies, the chief of the people of Dan being Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.
- 26 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were threescore and two thousand and seven hundred.* His company as listed being 62,700.
- 27 *And those that encamp by him shall be the tribe of Asher: and the captain of the children of Asher shall be Pagiel the son of Ocran.* those to camp next to him shall be the tribe of Asher, the chief of the people of Asher being Pagiel the son of Ocran,
- 28 *And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty and one thousand and five hundred.* his company as listed being 41,500.
- 29 *Then the tribe of Naphtali: and the captain of the children of Naphtali shall be Ahira the son of Enan.* Then the tribe of Naphtali, the chief of the people of Naphtali being Ahira the son of Enan,

- 30 *And those that were numbered thereof* his company as listed being 53,400.
were fifty and three thousand and four
hundred.
- 31 *All they that were numbered in the* The whole number of the camp of Dan
camp of Dan were an hundred is 157,600. They shall set out last by
thousand and fifty and seven thousand their standards.'
and six hundred. They shall go
hindmost with their standards.
- 32 *These are those which were numbered* These are the people of Israel as listed
of the children of Israel by the house by their fathers' houses. All who were
of their fathers: all those that were listed in the camps by their companies
numbered of the camps throughout were 603,550.
their hosts were six hundred thousand
and three thousand and five hundred
and fifty.
- 33 *But the Levites were not numbered* But the Levites were not listed among
among the children of Israel; as the the children of Israel, as the LORD
LORD commanded Moses. commanded Moses.
- 34 *And the children of Israel did* Thus the children of Israel did
according to all that the LORD according to all that the LORD
commanded Moses: so they pitched by commanded Moses; so they camped by
their standards, and so they set their standards, and so they set out,
forward, every one after their each one in his clan, according to his
families, according to the house of father's house.
their fathers.

Words in this chapter:

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Cor 14:40
- v3 — Ruth 4:20; 1 Chr 2:10
- v9 — Num 10:14
- v16 — Num 10:18
- v24 — Num 10:22
- v31 — Num 10:25
- v32 — Num 1:46
- v34 — Ps 119:6

Chapter 3

The LORD takes the Levites in place of all the firstborn of Israel, numbering 22,000 Levite males from a month old and upward. The clans of Gershon, Kohath, and Merari are each assigned positions around the tabernacle and specific duties for its care; the 273 excess firstborn are redeemed with silver.

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| 1 | <i>These also are the generations of Aaron and Moses in the day that the LORD spake with Moses in mount Sinai.</i> | These are the generations of Aaron and Moses at the time when the LORD spoke with Moses on Mount Sinai. |
| 2 | <i>And these are the names of the sons of Aaron; Nadab the firstborn, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.</i> | These are the names of the sons of Aaron: Nadab the firstborn, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. |
| 3 | <i>These are the names of the sons of Aaron, the priests which were anointed, whom he consecrated to minister in the priest's office.</i> | These are the names of the sons of Aaron, the anointed priests, whom he ordained to serve as priests. |
| 4 | <i>And Nadab and Abihu died before the LORD, when they offered strange fire before the LORD, in the wilderness of Sinai, and they had no children: and Eleazar and Ithamar ministered in the priest's office in the sight of Aaron their father.</i> | But Nadab and Abihu died before the LORD when they offered unauthorized fire before the LORD in the wilderness of Sinai. They had no children. So Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests in the lifetime of Aaron their father. |

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| 5 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 6 | <i>Bring the tribe of Levi near, and present them before Aaron the priest, that they may minister unto him.</i> | 'Bring the tribe of Levi near, and set them before Aaron the priest, that they may minister to him. |
| 7 | <i>And they shall keep his charge, and the charge of the whole congregation before the tabernacle of the congregation, to do the service of the tabernacle.</i> | They shall keep guard over him and over the whole congregation before the tent of meeting, as they minister at the tabernacle. |
| 8 | <i>And they shall keep all the instruments of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the charge of the children of Israel, to do the service of the tabernacle.</i> | They shall guard all the furnishings of the tent of meeting, and keep guard over the children of Israel as they minister at the tabernacle. |
| 9 | <i>And thou shalt give the Levites unto Aaron and to his sons: they are wholly given unto him out of the children of Israel.</i> | you shall give the Levites to Aaron and his sons; they are wholly given to him from among the children of Israel. |
| 10 | <i>And thou shalt appoint Aaron and his sons, and they shall wait on their priest's office: and the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.</i> | you shall appoint Aaron and his sons. They shall guard their priesthood. But if any outsider comes near, he shall be put to death.' |
| 11 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 12 | <i>And I, behold, I have taken the Levites from among the children of Israel instead of all the firstborn that openeth the matrix among the children of Israel: therefore the Levites shall be mine;</i> | ' I have taken the Levites from among the children of Israel instead of every firstborn who opens the womb among the children of Israel. The Levites shall be mine, |

- 13 *Because all the firstborn are mine; for on the day that I smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt I hallowed unto me all the firstborn in Israel, both man and beast: mine shall they be: I am the LORD.* for all the firstborn are mine. On the day that I struck down all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, I consecrated for my own all the firstborn in Israel, both of man and of beast. They shall be mine: I am the LORD.'
- 14 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, saying,
- 15 *Number the children of Levi after the house of their fathers, by their families: every male from a month old and upward shalt thou number them.* 'List the sons of Levi, by fathers' houses and by clans; every male from a month old and upward You shall list.'
- 16 *And Moses numbered them according to the word of the LORD, as he was commanded.* So Moses listed them according to the word of the LORD, as He was commanded.
- 17 *And these were the sons of Levi by their names; Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari.* these were the sons of Levi by their names: Gershon and Kohath and Merari.
- 18 *And these are the names of the sons of Gershon by their families; Libni, and Shimei.* these are the names of the sons of Gershon by their clans: Libni and Shimei.
- 19 *And the sons of Kohath by their families; Amram, and Izebar, Hebron, and Uzziel.* the sons of Kohath by their clans: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.
- 20 *And the sons of Merari by their families; Mahli, and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to the house of their fathers.* the sons of Merari by their clans: Mahli and Mushi. These are the clans of the Levites, by their fathers' houses.
- 21 *Of Gershon was the family of the Libnites, and the family of the Shimites: these are the families of the Gershonites.* From Gershon came the clan of the Libnites and the clan of the Shimeites; these are the clans of the Gershonites.

- 22 *Those that were numbered of them, according to the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, even those that were numbered of them were seven thousand and five hundred.* Their listing according to the number of all the males from a month old and upward — those listed were 7,500.
- 23 *The families of the Gershonites shall pitch behind the tabernacle westward.* The clans of the Gershonites were to camp behind the tabernacle, to the west.
- 24 *And the chief of the house of the father of the Gershonites shall be Eliasaph the son of Lael.* with Eliasaph the son of Lael as chief of the fathers' house of the Gershonites.
- 25 *And the charge of the sons of Gershon in the tabernacle of the congregation shall be the tabernacle, and the tent, the covering thereof, and the hanging for the door of the tabernacle of the congregation,* the guard duty of the sons of Gershon in the tent of meeting involved the tabernacle and the tent, its covering and the screen for the entrance of the tent of meeting,
- 26 *And the hangings of the court, and the curtain for the door of the court, which is by the tabernacle, and by the altar round about, and the cords of it for all the service thereof.* the hangings of the court, the screen for the gate of the court that is around the tabernacle and the altar, and its cords — all the service relating to these.
- 27 *And of Kohath was the family of the Amramites, and the family of the Izecharites, and the family of the Hebronites, and the family of the Uzzielites: these are the families of the Kohathites.* from Kohath came the clan of the Amramites, the clan of the Izharites, the clan of the Hebronites, and the clan of the Uzzielites; these are the clans of the Kohathites.
- 28 *In the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, were eight thousand and six hundred, keeping the charge of the sanctuary.* According to the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, there were 8,600, keeping guard over the sanctuary.

- 29 *The families of the sons of Kohath shall pitch on the side of the tabernacle southward.* The clans of the sons of Kohath were to camp on the south side of the tabernacle,
- 30 *And the chief of the house of the father of the families of the Kohathites shall be Elizaphan the son of Uzziel.* with Elizaphan the son of Uzziel as chief of the fathers' house of the clans of the Kohathites.
- 31 *And their charge shall be the ark, and the table, and the candlestick, and the altars, and the vessels of the sanctuary wherewith they minister, and the hanging, and all the service thereof.* their guard duty involved the ark, the table, the lampstand, the altars, the vessels of the sanctuary with which the priests minister, and the screen; all the service relating to these.
- 32 *And Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall be chief over the chief of the Levites, and have the oversight of them that keep the charge of the sanctuary.* Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest was to be chief over the chiefs of the Levites, and to have oversight of those who kept guard over the sanctuary.
- 33 *Of Merari was the family of the Mahlites, and the family of the Mushites: these are the families of Merari.* From Merari came the clan of the Mahlites and the clan of the Mushites; these are the clans of Merari.
- 34 *And those that were numbered of them, according to the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, were six thousand and two hundred.* According to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, those listed were 6,200.

■ **NAME NOTE** Zuriel (ZOOR-ee-el) — "God is my rock" Chief of the Merarite Levites. Son of Abihail. Abihail (AB-ih-hale) — "Father of strength" Father of Zuriel, leader of the Merarites.

- 35 *And the chief of the house of the father of the families of Merari was Zuriel the son of Abihail: these shall pitch on the side of the tabernacle northward.* the chief of the fathers' house of the clans of Merari was Zuriel the son of Abihail; they were to camp on the north side of the tabernacle.

- 36 *And under the custody and charge of the sons of Merari shall be the boards of the tabernacle, and the bars thereof, and the pillars thereof, and the sockets thereof, and all the vessels thereof, and all that serveth thereto,* the appointed guard duty of the sons of Merari involved the frames of the tabernacle, the bars, the pillars, the bases. All their accessories — all the service relating to these;
- 37 *And the pillars of the court round about, and their sockets, and their pins, and their cords.* also the pillars around the court with their bases, pegs, and cords.
- 38 *But those that encamp before the tabernacle toward the east, even before the tabernacle of the congregation eastward, shall be Moses, and Aaron and his sons, keeping the charge of the sanctuary for the charge of the children of Israel; and the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.* those who were to camp before the tabernacle on the east, before the tent of meeting toward the sunrise, were Moses and Aaron and his sons, guarding the sanctuary itself, to protect the children of Israel. And any outsider who came near was to be put to death.
- 39 *All that were numbered of the Levites, which Moses and Aaron numbered at the commandment of the LORD, throughout their families, all the males from a month old and upward, were twenty and two thousand.* All those listed of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron listed at the commandment of the LORD, by clans, all the males from a month old and upward, were 22,000.
- 40 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Number all the firstborn of the males of the children of Israel from a month old and upward, and take the number of their names.* the LORD said to Moses, 'List all the firstborn males of the children of Israel, from a month old and upward, taking the number of their names.
- 41 *And thou shalt take the Levites for me (I am the LORD) instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel; and the cattle of the Levites instead of all the firstlings among the cattle of the children of Israel.* you shall take the Levites for me — I am the LORD — instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the cattle of the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the cattle of the children of Israel.'

- 42 *And Moses numbered, as the LORD commanded him, all the firstborn among the children of Israel.* So Moses listed all the firstborn among the children of Israel, as the LORD commanded Him.
- 43 *And all the firstborn males by the number of names, from a month old and upward, of those that were numbered of them, were twenty and two thousand two hundred and threescore and thirteen.* all the firstborn males, according to the number of names, from a month old and upward, as listed, were 22,273.
- 44 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 45 *Take the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the cattle of the Levites instead of their cattle; and the Levites shall be mine: I am the LORD.* 'Take the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the cattle of the Levites instead of their cattle. The Levites shall be mine: I am the LORD.
- 46 *And for those that are to be redeemed of the two hundred and threescore and thirteen of the firstborn of the children of Israel, which are more than the Levites;* as the ransom for the 273 of the firstborn of the children of Israel, over and above the number of the Levites,
- 47 *Thou shalt even take five shekels apiece by the poll, after the shekel of the sanctuary shalt thou take them: (the shekel is twenty gerahs:)* you shall take five shekels per head; You shall take them according to the shekel of the sanctuary (the shekel of twenty gerahs),
- 48 *And thou shalt give the money, wherewith the odd number of them is to be redeemed, unto Aaron and to his sons.* give the money to Aaron and his sons as the ransom for those who are over.'
- 49 *And Moses took the redemption money of them that were over and above them that were redeemed by the Levites:* So Moses took the redemption money from those who were over and above those redeemed by the Levites.

- 50 *Of the firstborn of the children of Israel took he the money; a thousand three hundred and threescore and five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary.* From the firstborn of the children of Israel he took the money, 1,365 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary.
- 51 *And Moses gave the money of them that were redeemed unto Aaron and to his sons, according to the word of the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.* Moses gave the redemption money to Aaron and his sons, according to the word of the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

poll — A single head — used in census contexts meaning 'per person'; 'every male by their polls' means 'each male individually.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Sinai (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 6:23

v3 — Ex 28:41

v4 — Lev 10:1-2; Num 26:61

v10 — Num 1:51

v13 — Luke 2:23; Ex 13:12

v15 — Num 26:62

v38 — Num 1:53; Num 3:10

v41 — Num 3:12

v46 — Ex 13:13

v47 — Lev 27:6; Ex 30:13

Chapter 4

The LORD gives instructions for the service of the Levite clans when the camp moves. The Kohathites carry the holy objects after Aaron's sons cover them, the Gershonites carry the curtains and coverings, and the Merarites carry the frames and pillars; the total number of Levites in service is 8,580.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying, |
| 2 <i>Take the sum of the sons of Kohath from among the sons of Levi, after their families, by the house of their fathers,</i> | 'Take a census of the sons of Kohath from among the sons of Levi, by their clans and their fathers' houses, |
| 3 <i>From thirty years old and upward even until fifty years old, all that enter into the host, to do the work in the tabernacle of the congregation.</i> | from thirty years old up to fifty years old, all who can come on duty, to do the work in the tent of meeting. |
| 4 <i>This shall be the service of the sons of Kohath in the tabernacle of the congregation, about the most holy things:</i> | This is the service of the sons of Kohath in the tent of meeting: the most holy things. |
| 5 <i>And when the camp setteth forward, Aaron shall come, and his sons, and they shall take down the covering vail, and cover the ark of testimony with it:</i> | When the camp is to set out, Aaron and his sons shall go in and take down the veil of the screen and cover the ark of the testimony with it. |
| 6 <i>And shall put thereon the covering of badgers' skins, and shall spread over it a cloth wholly of blue, and shall put in the staves thereof.</i> | Then they shall put on it a covering of goatskin and spread on top of that a cloth all of blue, and shall put its poles in place. |
| 7 <i>And upon the table of shewbread they shall spread a cloth of blue, and put thereon the dishes, and the spoons, and the bowls, and covers to cover withal: and the continual bread shall be thereon:</i> | over the table of the bread of the Presence they shall spread a cloth of blue and put on it the plates, the dishes for incense, the bowls, and the flagons for the drink offering; the regular showbread also shall be on it. |

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| <p>8 <i>And they shall spread upon them a cloth of scarlet, and cover the same with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put in the staves thereof.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And they shall take a cloth of blue, and cover the candlestick of the light, and his lamps, and his tongs, and his snuffdishes, and all the oil vessels thereof, wherewith they minister unto it:</i></p> <p>10 <i>And they shall put it and all the vessels thereof within a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put it upon a bar.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And upon the golden altar they shall spread a cloth of blue, and cover it with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put to the staves thereof:</i></p> <p>12 <i>And they shall take all the instruments of ministry, wherewith they minister in the sanctuary, and put them in a cloth of blue, and cover them with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put them on a bar:</i></p> <p>13 <i>And they shall take away the ashes from the altar, and spread a purple cloth thereon:</i></p> <p>14 <i>And they shall put upon it all the vessels thereof, wherewith they minister about it, even the censers, the fleshhooks, and the shovels, and the basons, all the vessels of the altar; and they shall spread upon it a covering of badgers' skins, and put to the staves of it.</i></p> | <p>Then they shall spread over them a cloth of scarlet and cover the same with a covering of goatskin, and shall put in its poles.</p> <p>they shall take a cloth of blue and cover the lampstand for the light, with its lamps, its tongs, its trays. All the vessels for oil with which it is tended.</p> <p>they shall put it with all its utensils in a covering of goatskin and put it on the carrying frame.</p> <p>over the golden altar they shall spread a cloth of blue and cover it with a covering of goatskin, and shall put in its poles.</p> <p>they shall take all the vessels of the service that are used in the sanctuary and put them in a cloth of blue and cover them with a covering of goatskin and put them on the carrying frame.</p> <p>they shall remove the ashes from the altar and spread a purple cloth over it.</p> <p>shall put on it all the utensils of the altar that are used for the service at the altar — the fire pans, the forks, the shovels, and the basins, all the utensils of the altar — and they shall spread on it a covering of goatskin, and shall put its poles in place.</p> |
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- 15 *And when Aaron and his sons have made an end of covering the sanctuary, and all the vessels of the sanctuary, as the camp is to set forward; after that, the sons of Kohath shall come to bear it: but they shall not touch any holy thing, lest they die. These things are the burden of the sons of Kohath in the tabernacle of the congregation.* when Aaron and his sons have finished covering the sanctuary and all the furnishings of the sanctuary, as the camp sets out, after that the sons of Kohath shall come to carry these. But They must not touch the holy things, lest they die. These are the things of the tent of meeting that the sons of Kohath are to carry.
- 16 *And to the office of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest pertaineth the oil for the light, and the sweet incense, and the daily meat offering, and the anointing oil, and the oversight of all the tabernacle, and of all that therein is, in the sanctuary, and in the vessels thereof.* Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall have charge of the oil for the light, the fragrant incense, the regular grain offering, and the anointing oil, with oversight of all the tabernacle and all that is in it, of the sanctuary and its vessels.'
- 17 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying,
- 18 *Cut ye not off the tribe of the families of the Kohathites from among the Levites:* 'Let not the tribe of the clans of the Kohathites be destroyed from among the Levites,
- 19 *But thus do unto them, that they may live, and not die, when they approach unto the most holy things: Aaron and his sons shall go in, and appoint them every one to his service and to his burden:* but deal with them in this way that they may live and not die when they come near to the most holy things: Aaron and his sons shall go in and appoint them each to his task and to his burden.
- 20 *But they shall not go in to see when the holy things are covered, lest they die.* But they shall not go in to look on the holy things even for a moment, lest they die.'
- 21 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 22 *Take also the sum of the sons of Gershon, throughout the houses of their fathers, by their families;* 'Take a census of the sons of Gershon also, by their fathers' houses and by their clans.
- 23 *From thirty years old and upward until fifty years old shalt thou number them; all that enter in to perform the service, to do the work in the tabernacle of the congregation.* From thirty years old up to fifty years old, You shall list them, all who can come to do duty, to do service in the tent of meeting.
- 24 *This is the service of the families of the Gershonites, to serve, and for burdens:* This is the service of the clans of the Gershonites, in serving and bearing burdens.
- 25 *And they shall bear the curtains of the tabernacle, and the tabernacle of the congregation, his covering, and the covering of the badgers' skins that is above upon it, and the hanging for the door of the tabernacle of the congregation,* They shall carry the curtains of the tabernacle and the tent of meeting with its covering and the covering of goatskin that is on top of it and the screen for the entrance of the tent of meeting
- 26 *And the hangings of the court, and the hanging for the door of the gate of the court, which is by the tabernacle and by the altar round about, and their cords, and all the instruments of their service, and all that is made for them: so shall they serve.* the hangings of the court and the screen for the gate of the court that is around the tabernacle and the altar. Their cords and all the equipment for their service. And they shall do all that needs to be done with regard to them.
- 27 *At the appointment of Aaron and his sons shall be all the service of the sons of the Gershonites, in all their burdens, and in all their service: and ye shall appoint unto them in charge all their burdens.* All the service of the sons of the Gershonites shall be at the command of Aaron and his sons, in all that they are to carry and in all that they have to do. And you shall assign to their charge all that they are to carry.

- 28 *This is the service of the families of the sons of Gershon in the tabernacle of the congregation: and their charge shall be under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.* This is the service of the clans of the sons of Gershon in the tent of meeting. Their guard duty is to be under the direction of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.
- 29 *As for the sons of Merari, thou shalt number them after their families, by the house of their fathers;* As for the sons of Merari, you shall list them by their clans and their fathers' houses.
- 30 *From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old shalt thou number them, every one that entereth into the service, to do the work of the tabernacle of the congregation.* From thirty years old up to fifty years old, you shall list them, everyone who can come on duty, to do the service of the tent of meeting.
- 31 *And this is the charge of their burden, according to all their service in the tabernacle of the congregation; the boards of the tabernacle, and the bars thereof, and the pillars thereof, and sockets thereof,* this is what they are charged to carry, as the whole of their service in the tent of meeting: the frames of the tabernacle, with its bars, pillars, and bases,
- 32 *And the pillars of the court round about, and their sockets, and their pins, and their cords, with all their instruments, and with all their service: and by name ye shall reckon the instruments of the charge of their burden.* the pillars around the court with their bases, pegs, and cords, with all their equipment and all their accessories. And you shall list by name the objects that they are required to carry.
- 33 *This is the service of the families of the sons of Merari, according to all their service, in the tabernacle of the congregation, under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.* This is the service of the clans of the sons of Merari, the whole of their service in the tent of meeting, under the direction of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.'
- 34 *And Moses and Aaron and the chief of the congregation numbered the sons of the Kohathites after their families, and after the house of their fathers,* Moses and Aaron and the chiefs of the congregation listed the sons of the Kohathites, by their clans and their fathers' houses,

- 35 *From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation:* from thirty years old up to fifty years old, everyone who could come on duty, for service in the tent of meeting;
- 36 *And those that were numbered of them by their families were two thousand seven hundred and fifty.* those listed of them by their clans were 2,750.
- 37 *These were they that were numbered of the families of the Kohathites, all that might do service in the tabernacle of the congregation, which Moses and Aaron did number according to the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.* These were the people listed of the clans of the Kohathites, all who served in the tent of meeting, whom Moses and Aaron listed according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses.
- 38 *And those that were numbered of the sons of Gershon, throughout their families, and by the house of their fathers,* Those listed of the sons of Gershon, by their clans and their fathers' houses,
- 39 *From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation:* from thirty years old up to fifty years old, everyone who could come on duty for service in the tent of meeting —
- 40 *Even those that were numbered of them, throughout their families, by the house of their fathers, were two thousand and six hundred and thirty.* those listed by their clans and fathers' houses were 2,630.
- 41 *These are they that were numbered of the families of the sons of Gershon, of all that might do service in the tabernacle of the congregation, whom Moses and Aaron did number according to the commandment of the LORD.* These are the people listed of the clans of the sons of Gershon, all who served in the tent of meeting, whom Moses and Aaron listed according to the commandment of the LORD.

- 42 *And those that were numbered of the families of the sons of Merari, throughout their families, by the house of their fathers,* Those listed of the clans of the sons of Merari, by their clans and their fathers' houses,
- 43 *From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation:* from thirty years old up to fifty years old, everyone who could come on duty for service in the tent of meeting —
- 44 *Even those that were numbered of them after their families, were three thousand and two hundred.* those listed by their clans were 3,200.
- 45 *These be those that were numbered of the families of the sons of Merari, whom Moses and Aaron numbered according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.* These are those listed of the clans of the sons of Merari, whom Moses and Aaron listed according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses.
- 46 *All those that were numbered of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron and the chief of Israel numbered, after their families, and after the house of their fathers,* All those who were listed of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron and the chiefs of Israel listed, by their clans and their fathers' houses,
- 47 *From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that came to do the service of the ministry, and the service of the burden in the tabernacle of the congregation,* from thirty years old up to fifty years old, everyone who could come to do the service of ministry and the service of bearing burdens in the tent of meeting —
- 48 *Even those that were numbered of them, were eight thousand and five hundred and fourscore.* those listed were 8,580.

- 49 *According to the commandment of the LORD they were numbered by the hand of Moses, every one according to his service, and according to his burden: thus were they numbered of him, as the LORD commanded Moses.* According to the commandment of the LORD, through Moses, each one was listed to his specific task of serving or carrying; thus they were listed by Moses, as the LORD commanded Him.

Words in this chapter:

- ark of the testimony** — Another name for the ark of the covenant — 'testimony' refers to the tablets of the law stored inside it.
- incense** — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.
- meat** — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.
- shewbread** (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'
- vail** — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

- v15** — 2 Sam 6:6-7; Num 7:9; Deut 31:9
- v16** — Ex 25:6
- v20** — 1 Sam 6:19; Ex 19:21
- v23** — Num 4:3
- v49** — Num 1:54

Chapter 5

The LORD commands the removal of unclean persons from the camp and gives laws requiring restitution for wrongs. He then gives the law of jealousy -- a test by bitter water to determine whether a wife has been unfaithful to her husband.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 2 *Command the children of Israel, that they put out of the camp every leper, and every one that hath an issue, and whosoever is defiled by the dead:* 'Command the children of Israel to put out of the camp every person with a skin disease and every person with a discharge and everyone who is unclean through contact with the dead.

- 3 *Both male and female shall ye put out, without the camp shall ye put them; that they defile not their camps, in the midst whereof I dwell.* You shall put out both male and female, putting them outside the camp, that they may not defile their camp, in the midst of which I dwell.'
- 4 *And the children of Israel did so, and put them out without the camp: as the LORD spake unto Moses, so did the children of Israel.* the children of Israel did so, and put them outside the camp; as the LORD said to Moses, so the children of Israel did.
- 5 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 6 *Speak unto the children of Israel, When a man or woman shall commit any sin that men commit, to do a trespass against the LORD, and that person be guilty;* 'Speak to the children of Israel, When a man or woman commits any of the sins that people commit by breaking faith with the LORD, and that person realizes His guilt,
- 7 *Then they shall confess their sin which they have done: and he shall recompense his trespass with the principal thereof, and add unto it the fifth part thereof, and give it unto him against whom he hath trespassed.* he shall confess His sin that He has committed. And He shall make full restitution for His wrong, adding a fifth to it and giving it to Him to whom He did the wrong.
- 8 *But if the man have no kinsman to recompense the trespass unto, let the trespass be recompensed unto the LORD, even to the priest; beside the ram of the atonement, whereby an atonement shall be made for him.* But if the man has no kinsman to whom restitution may be made for the wrong, the restitution for wrong shall go to the LORD for the priest, in addition to the ram of atonement with which atonement is made for Him.
- 9 *And every offering of all the holy things of the children of Israel, which they bring unto the priest, shall be his.* every contribution, all the holy things of the children of Israel, which they bring to the priest, shall be his.
- 10 *And every man's hallowed things shall be his: whatsoever any man giveth the priest, it shall be his.* Each one shall keep his own holy things: whatever anyone gives to the priest shall be his.'

- 11 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 12 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, If any man's wife go aside, and commit a trespass against him,* 'Speak to the children of Israel, If any man's wife goes astray and breaks faith with Him,
- 13 *And a man lie with her carnally, and it be hid from the eyes of her husband, and be kept close, and she be defiled, and there be no witness against her, neither she be taken with the manner;* if a man lies with her sexually. It is hidden from the eyes of her husband. She is undetected though she has defiled herself, and there is no witness against her, since she was not caught in the act,
- 14 *And the spirit of jealousy come upon him, and he be jealous of his wife, and she be defiled: or if the spirit of jealousy come upon him, and he be jealous of his wife, and she be not defiled:* if the spirit of jealousy comes over Him and He is jealous of his wife who has defiled herself, or if the spirit of jealousy comes over Him and He is jealous of his wife, though she has not defiled herself,
- 15 *Then shall the man bring his wife unto the priest, and he shall bring her offering for her, the tenth part of an ephah of barley meal; he shall pour no oil upon it, nor put frankincense thereon; for it is an offering of jealousy, an offering of memorial, bringing iniquity to remembrance.* then the man shall bring his wife to the priest and bring the offering required of her, a tenth of an ephah of barley flour. He shall pour no oil on it and put no frankincense on it, for it is a grain offering of jealousy, a grain offering of remembrance, bringing iniquity to remembrance.
- 16 *And the priest shall bring her near, and set her before the LORD:* the priest shall bring her near and set her before the LORD.
- 17 *And the priest shall take holy water in an earthen vessel; and of the dust that is in the floor of the tabernacle the priest shall take, and put it into the water:* the priest shall take holy water in an earthenware vessel and take some of the dust that is on the floor of the tabernacle and put it into the water.

- 18 *And the priest shall set the woman before the LORD, and uncover the woman's head, and put the offering of memorial in her hands, which is the jealousy offering: and the priest shall have in his hand the bitter water that causeth the curse:* the priest shall set the woman before the LORD and unbind the hair of the woman's head and place in her hands the grain offering of remembrance, which is the grain offering of jealousy. And in His hand the priest shall have the water of bitterness that brings the curse.
- 19 *And the priest shall charge her by an oath, and say unto the woman, If no man have lain with thee, and if thou hast not gone aside to uncleanness with another instead of thy husband, be thou free from this bitter water that causeth the curse:* Then the priest shall make her take an oath, saying to her, If no man has lain with you, and if you have not turned aside to uncleanness while under your husband's authority, be free from this water of bitterness that brings the curse.
- 20 *But if thou hast gone aside to another instead of thy husband, and if thou be defiled, and some man have lain with thee beside thine husband:* But if you have gone astray, though you are under your husband's authority, and if you have defiled yourself. Some man other than your husband has lain with you,
- 21 *Then the priest shall charge the woman with an oath of cursing, and the priest shall say unto the woman, The LORD make thee a curse and an oath among thy people, when the LORD doth make thy thigh to rot, and thy belly to swell;* then (the priest shall make the woman take the oath of the curse, and the priest shall say to the woman), the LORD make You a curse and an oath among Your people, when the LORD makes Your thigh fall away and Your body swell.
- 22 *And this water that causeth the curse shall go into thy bowels, to make thy belly to swell, and thy thigh to rot: And the woman shall say, Amen, amen.* May this water that brings the curse pass into your bowels and make your womb swell and your thigh fall away. And the woman shall say, Amen, Amen.
- 23 *And the priest shall write these curses in a book, and he shall blot them out with the bitter water:* Then the priest shall write these curses in a book and wash them off into the water of bitterness.

- 24 *And he shall cause the woman to drink the bitter water that causeth the curse: and the water that causeth the curse shall enter into her, and become bitter.* he shall make the woman drink the water of bitterness that brings the curse, and the water that brings the curse shall enter into her and cause bitter pain.
- 25 *Then the priest shall take the jealousy offering out of the woman's hand, and shall wave the offering before the LORD, and offer it upon the altar:* the priest shall take the grain offering of jealousy out of the woman's hand and shall wave the grain offering before the LORD and bring it to the altar.
- 26 *And the priest shall take an handful of the offering, even the memorial thereof, and burn it upon the altar, and afterward shall cause the woman to drink the water.* the priest shall take a handful of the grain offering, as its memorial portion, and burn it on the altar, and afterward shall make the woman drink the water.
- 27 *And when he hath made her to drink the water, then it shall come to pass, that, if she be defiled, and have done trespass against her husband, that the water that causeth the curse shall enter into her, and become bitter, and her belly shall swell, and her thigh shall rot: and the woman shall be a curse among her people.* when he has made her drink the water, then, if she has defiled herself and has broken faith with her husband, the water that brings the curse shall enter into her and cause bitter pain. Her womb shall swell. Her thigh shall fall away, and the woman shall become a curse among her people.
- 28 *And if the woman be not defiled, but be clean; then she shall be free, and shall conceive seed.* But if the woman has not defiled herself and is clean, then she shall be free and shall conceive children.
- 29 *This is the law of jealousies, when a wife goeth aside to another instead of her husband, and is defiled;* This is the law in cases of jealousy, when a wife, though under her husband's authority, goes astray and defiles herself,

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Or when the spirit of jealousy cometh upon him, and he be jealous over his wife, and shall set the woman before the LORD, and the priest shall execute upon her all this law.

or when the spirit of jealousy comes over a man and he is jealous over his wife. Then he shall set the woman before the LORD, and the priest shall execute all this law over her.
- 31

Then shall the man be guiltless from iniquity, and this woman shall bear her iniquity.

The man shall be free from iniquity, but the woman shall bear her iniquity.'

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Lev 13:46; Lev 21:1
- v3 — Deut 23:14
- v6 — Lev 5:1-4
- v7 — Lev 5:5; Lev 26:40; Josh 7:19
- v13 — Lev 18:20; Lev 20:10
- v14 — Song 8:6; Prov 6:34
- v15 — Ezek 29:16
- v22 — Ps 109:18
- v26 — Lev 2:2
- v27 — Jer 29:18; Jer 42:18; Zech 8:13
- v29 — Num 5:19

Chapter 6

The LORD gives the law of the Nazirite vow: the person must abstain from wine, not cut his hair, and avoid contact with the dead for the duration of the vow. The chapter concludes with the Aaronic blessing: 'The LORD bless thee, and keep thee.'

- 1

And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 2

Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When either man or woman shall separate themselves to vow a vow of a Nazarite, to separate themselves unto the LORD:

'Speak to the children of Israel and say to them, When either a man or a woman makes a special vow, the vow of a Nazarite, to separate Himself to the LORD,

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| 3 | <i>He shall separate himself from wine and strong drink, and shall drink no vinegar of wine, or vinegar of strong drink, neither shall he drink any liquor of grapes, nor eat moist grapes, or dried.</i> | he shall abstain from wine and strong drink. He shall drink no vinegar made from wine or strong drink and shall not drink any juice of grapes or eat grapes, fresh or dried. |
| 4 | <i>All the days of his separation shall he eat nothing that is made of the vine tree, from the kernels even to the husk.</i> | All the days of His separation He shall eat nothing produced by the grapevine, not even the seeds or the skins. |
| 5 | <i>All the days of the vow of his separation there shall no razor come upon his head: until the days be fulfilled, in the which he separateth himself unto the LORD, he shall be holy, and shall let the locks of the hair of his head grow.</i> | All the days of His vow of separation, no razor shall come upon His head. Until the time is completed for which He separates Himself to the LORD, He shall be holy. He shall let the locks of hair on His head grow long. |
| 6 | <i>All the days that he separateth himself unto the LORD he shall come at no dead body.</i> | All the days that He separates Himself to the LORD He shall not go near a dead body. |
| 7 | <i>He shall not make himself unclean for his father, or for his mother, for his brother, or for his sister, when they die: because the consecration of his God is upon his head.</i> | Not even for His father or for His mother, for brother or sister, if they die, shall He make Himself unclean, because His separation to God is on His head. |
| 8 | <i>All the days of his separation he is holy unto the LORD.</i> | All the days of His separation He is holy to the LORD. |
| 9 | <i>And if any man die very suddenly by him, and he hath defiled the head of his consecration; then he shall shave his head in the day of his cleansing, on the seventh day shall he shave it.</i> | if any man dies very suddenly beside Him and He defiles His consecrated head, then He shall shave His head on the day of His cleansing; on the seventh day He shall shave it. |
| 10 | <i>And on the eighth day he shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons, to the priest, to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:</i> | on the eighth day he shall bring two turtledoves or two young pigeons to the priest at the entrance of the tent of meeting, |

- 11 *And the priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, and make an atonement for him, for that he sinned by the dead, and shall hallow his head that same day.* the priest shall offer one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering, and make atonement for him, because he sinned by reason of the dead body. And he shall consecrate his head that same day
- 12 *And he shall consecrate unto the LORD the days of his separation, and shall bring a lamb of the first year for a trespass offering; but the days that were before shall be lost, because his separation was defiled.* separate Himself to the LORD for the days of His separation and bring a male lamb a year old for a guilt offering. But the previous days shall be void, because His separation was defiled.
- 13 *And this is the law of the Nazarite, when the days of his separation are fulfilled: he shall be brought unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:* this is the law for the Nazarite, when the time of His separation has been completed: He shall be brought to the entrance of the tabernacle of the congregation,
- 14 *And he shall offer his offering unto the LORD, one he lamb of the first year without blemish for a burnt offering, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish for a sin offering, and one ram without blemish for peace offerings,* he shall bring His gift to the LORD, one male lamb a year old without blemish for a burnt offering, and one ewe lamb a year old without blemish as a sin offering, and one ram without blemish as a peace offering,
- 15 *And a basket of unleavened bread, cakes of fine flour mingled with oil, and wafers of unleavened bread anointed with oil, and their meat offering, and their drink offerings.* a basket of unleavened bread, loaves of fine flour mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers smeared with oil. Their grain offering and their drink offerings.
- 16 *And the priest shall bring them before the LORD, and shall offer his sin offering, and his burnt offering:* the priest shall bring them before the LORD and offer His sin offering and His burnt offering,

- 17 *And he shall offer the ram for a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD, with the basket of unleavened bread: the priest shall offer also his meat offering, and his drink offering.* he shall offer the ram as a sacrifice of peace offering to the LORD, with the basket of unleavened bread. The priest shall offer also its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 18 *And the Nazarite shall shave the head of his separation at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall take the hair of the head of his separation, and put it in the fire which is under the sacrifice of the peace offerings.* the Nazarite shall shave His consecrated head at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall take the hair of His consecrated head and put it in the fire that is under the sacrifice of the peace offering.
- 19 *And the priest shall take the sodden shoulder of the ram, and one unleavened cake out of the basket, and one unleavened wafer, and shall put them upon the hands of the Nazarite, after the hair of his separation is shaven:* the priest shall take the boiled shoulder of the ram and one unleavened loaf out of the basket and one unleavened wafer, and shall put them on the hands of the Nazarite after the hair of his separation is shaven,
- 20 *And the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD: this is holy for the priest, with the wave breast and heave shoulder: and after that the Nazarite may drink wine.* the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. They are a holy portion for the priest, together with the breast that is waved and the thigh that is contributed. And after that the Nazarite may drink wine.
- 21 *This is the law of the Nazarite who hath vowed, and of his offering unto the LORD for his separation, beside that that his hand shall get: according to the vow which he vowed, so he must do after the law of his separation.* This is the law of the Nazarite who hath vowed, and of His offering unto the LORD for His separation, beside that that His hand shall get: according to the vow which He vowed, so He must do after the law of His separation.'
- 22 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

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| 23 | <i>Speak unto Aaron and unto his sons, saying, On this wise ye shall bless the children of Israel, saying unto them,</i> | 'Speak to Aaron and his sons, saying, Thus you shall bless the people of Israel: you shall say to them, |
| 24 | <i>The LORD bless thee, and keep thee:</i> | The LORD bless You and keep You; |
| 25 | <i>The LORD make his face shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee:</i> | The LORD make His face shine on You and be gracious to You; |
| 26 | <i>The LORD lift up his countenance upon thee, and give thee peace.</i> | The LORD lift up His countenance upon You and give You peace. |
| 27 | <i>And they shall put my name upon the children of Israel; and I will bless them.</i> | So shall they put my name upon the people of Israel. I will bless them.' |
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Words in this chapter:

Nazirite (*NAZ-ih-ryte*) — A person under a special vow of separation to God — forbidden from cutting hair, drinking wine, or touching a dead body; Samson and John the Baptist were Nazirites.

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

trespass offering — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Cross-References:

v2 — Judg 13:5; Amos 2:11-12; Rom 1:1

v3 — Luke 1:15

v5 — 1 Sam 1:11

v13 — Acts 21:26

v15 — Lev 2:4; Ex 29:2

v18 — Acts 21:24

v23 — 1 Chr 23:13; Deut 21:5; Gen 48:20

v24 — 1 Thess 5:23; Ps 121:4-7; Phil 4:7; Jude 1:24; Isa 42:6

v25 — Ps 80:19; Ps 119:135; Ps 31:16; Ps 67:1; Dan 9:17

v26 — Ps 4:6; Ps 29:11; 2 Thess 3:16; Rom 15:13; John 16:33

v27 — 2 Chr 7:14; Dan 9:18-19; Deut 28:10; Eph 1:3; Jer 14:9

Chapter 7

The twelve tribal leaders bring offerings for the dedication of the altar over twelve days, each leader bringing identical gifts on his appointed day. Their offerings include silver plates, golden dishes of incense, bulls, rams, lambs, and goats.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass on the day that Moses had fully set up the tabernacle, and had anointed it, and sanctified it, and all the instruments thereof, both the altar and all the vessels thereof, and had anointed them, and sanctified them;</i> | On the day when Moses had finished setting up the tabernacle and had anointed and consecrated it with all its furnishings and had anointed and consecrated the altar with all its utensils, |
| 2 | <i>That the princes of Israel, heads of the house of their fathers, who were the princes of the tribes, and were over them that were numbered, offered:</i> | the chiefs of Israel, heads of their fathers' houses, who were the chiefs of the tribes, who were over those who were listed, came forward |
| 3 | <i>And they brought their offering before the LORD, six covered wagons, and twelve oxen; a wagon for two of the princes, and for each one an ox: and they brought them before the tabernacle.</i> | brought their offerings before the LORD, six wagons and twelve oxen, a wagon for every two of the chiefs and for each one an ox. They brought them before the tabernacle. |
| 4 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | Then the LORD said to Moses, |
| 5 | <i>Take it of them, that they may be to do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation; and thou shalt give them unto the Levites, to every man according to his service.</i> | 'Accept these from them, that they may be used in the service of the tent of meeting, and give them to the Levites, to each man according to his service.' |
| 6 | <i>And Moses took the wagons and the oxen, and gave them unto the Levites.</i> | So Moses took the wagons and the oxen and gave them to the Levites. |
| 7 | <i>Two wagons and four oxen he gave unto the sons of Gershon, according to their service:</i> | Two wagons and four oxen he gave to the sons of Gershon, according to their service. |

- 8 *And four wagons and eight oxen he gave unto the sons of Merari, according unto their service, under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.* four wagons and eight oxen he gave to the sons of Merari, according to their service, under the direction of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.
- 9 *But unto the sons of Kohath he gave none: because the service of the sanctuary belonging unto them was that they should bear upon their shoulders.* But to the sons of Kohath he gave none, because they were charged with the service of the holy things that had to be carried on the shoulder.
- 10 *And the princes offered for dedicating of the altar in the day that it was anointed, even the princes offered their offering before the altar.* the chiefs offered offerings for the dedication of the altar on the day it was anointed. The chiefs offered their offering before the altar.
- 11 *And the LORD said unto Moses, They shall offer their offering, each prince on his day, for the dedicating of the altar.* the LORD said to Moses, 'They shall offer their offerings, one chief each day, for the dedication of the altar.'
- 12 *And he that offered his offering the first day was Nahshon the son of Amminadab, of the tribe of Judah:* He who offered his offering the first day was Nahshon the son of Amminadab, of the tribe of Judah.
- 13 *And his offering was one silver charger, the weight thereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them were full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* His offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 14 *One spoon of ten shekels of gold, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 15 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 16 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;

- 17 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Nahshon the son of Amminadab.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Nahshon the son of Amminadab.
- 18 *On the second day Nethaneel the son of Zuar, prince of Issachar, did offer:* On the second day Nethanel the son of Zuar, the chief of Issachar, made an offering.
- 19 *He offered for his offering one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* He offered for His offering one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 20 *One spoon of gold of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 21 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 22 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 23 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Nethaneel the son of Zuar.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Nethanel the son of Zuar.
- 24 *On the third day Eliab the son of Helon, prince of the children of Zebulun, did offer:* On the third day Eliab the son of Helon, the chief of the people of Zebulun:

- 25 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 26 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 27 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 28 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 29 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Eliab the son of Helon.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Eliab the son of Helon.
- 30 *On the fourth day Elizur the son of Shedeur, prince of the children of Reuben, did offer:* On the fourth day Elizur the son of Shedeur, the chief of the people of Reuben:
- 31 *His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 32 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 33 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 34 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;

- 35 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Elizur the son of Shedeur.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Elizur the son of Shedeur.
- 36 *On the fifth day Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai, prince of the children of Simeon, did offer:* On the fifth day Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai, the chief of the people of Simeon:
- 37 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 38 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 39 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 40 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 41 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.
- 42 *On the sixth day Eliasaph the son of Deuel, prince of the children of Gad, offered:* On the sixth day Eliasaph the son of Deuel, the chief of the people of Gad:

- 43 *His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, a silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 44 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 45 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 46 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 47 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Eliasaph the son of Deuel.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Eliasaph the son of Deuel.
- 48 *On the seventh day Elishama the son of Ammihud, prince of the children of Ephraim, offered:* On the seventh day Elishama the son of Ammihud, the chief of the people of Ephraim:
- 49 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 50 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 51 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 52 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;

- 53 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Elishama the son of Ammihud.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Elishama the son of Ammihud.
- 54 *On the eighth day offered Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur, prince of the children of Manasseh:* On the eighth day Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur, the chief of the people of Manasseh:
- 55 *His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 56 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 57 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 58 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 59 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.
- 60 *On the ninth day Abidan the son of Gideoni, prince of the children of Benjamin, offered:* On the ninth day Abidan the son of Gideoni, the chief of the people of Benjamin:

- 61 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 62 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 63 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 64 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 65 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Abidan the son of Gideoni.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Abidan the son of Gideoni.
- 66 *On the tenth day Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai, prince of the children of Dan, offered:* On the tenth day Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai, the chief of the people of Dan:
- 67 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 68 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 69 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 70 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;

- 71 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.
- 72 *On the eleventh day Pagiel the son of Ocran, prince of the children of Asher, offered:* On the eleventh day Pagiel the son of Ocran, the chief of the people of Asher:
- 73 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 74 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 75 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 76 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 77 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Pagiel the son of Ocran.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Pagiel the son of Ocran.
- 78 *On the twelfth day Ahira the son of Enan, prince of the children of Naphtali, offered:* On the twelfth day Ahira the son of Enan, the chief of the people of Naphtali:

- 79 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:* his offering was one silver plate whose weight was 130 shekels, one silver basin of 70 shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a grain offering;
- 80 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:* one golden dish of 10 shekels, full of incense;
- 81 *One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:* one bull from the herd, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
- 82 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:* one male goat for a sin offering;
- 83 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Ahira the son of Enan.* for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Ahira the son of Enan.
- 84 *This was the dedication of the altar, in the day when it was anointed, by the princes of Israel: twelve chargers of silver, twelve silver bowls, twelve spoons of gold:* This was the dedication offering for the altar on the day when it was anointed, from the chiefs of Israel: twelve silver plates, twelve silver basins, twelve golden dishes,
- 85 *Each charger of silver weighing an hundred and thirty shekels, each bowl seventy: all the silver vessels weighed two thousand and four hundred shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary:* each silver plate weighing 130 shekels and each basin 70, all the silver of the vessels 2,400 shekels by the shekel of the sanctuary,
- 86 *The golden spoons were twelve, full of incense, weighing ten shekels apiece, after the shekel of the sanctuary: all the gold of the spoons was an hundred and twenty shekels.* the twelve golden dishes, full of incense, weighing 10 shekels apiece by the shekel of the sanctuary, all the gold of the dishes being 120 shekels;

- 87 *All the oxen for the burnt offering were twelve bullocks, the rams twelve, the lambs of the first year twelve, with their meat offering: and the kids of the goats for sin offering twelve.* all the cattle for the burnt offering twelve bulls, twelve rams, twelve male lambs a year old, with their grain offering. Twelve male goats for a sin offering;
- 88 *And all the oxen for the sacrifice of the peace offerings were twenty and four bullocks, the rams sixty, the he goats sixty, the lambs of the first year sixty. This was the dedication of the altar, after that it was anointed.* all the cattle for the sacrifice of peace offerings twenty-four bulls, the rams sixty, the male goats sixty, the male lambs a year old sixty. This was the dedication offering for the altar after it was anointed.
- 89 *And when Moses was gone into the tabernacle of the congregation to speak with him, then he heard the voice of one speaking unto him from off the mercy seat that was upon the ark of testimony, from between the two cherubims: and he spake unto him.* when Moses went into the tent of meeting to speak with the LORD, He heard the voice speaking to Him from above the mercy seat that was on the ark of the testimony, from between the two cherubim. It spoke to Him.

Words in this chapter:

mercy seat — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 8:10-11
- v10 — 2 Chr 7:9
- v16 — Lev 4:23
- v42 — Num 1:14
- v48 — Num 1:10
- v60 — Num 1:11
- v66 — Num 1:12
- v72 — Num 1:13
- v78 — Num 1:15
- v88 — Num 7:1; Num 7:10

v89 — Heb 4:16; Ps 99:1; Ex 33:9-11; Ps 80:1; Ex 25:18-22

Chapter 8

The LORD instructs Moses to set up the lampstand and to consecrate the Levites for service by sprinkling them with water of purification, shaving their bodies, and offering sacrifices. The Levites are set apart from the rest of Israel as a wave offering to the LORD, serving in the tent of meeting from age twenty-five to fifty.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him, When thou lightest the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light over against the candlestick.</i> | 'Speak to Aaron and say to him, When you set up the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the lampstand.' |
| 3 | <i>And Aaron did so; he lighted the lamps thereof over against the candlestick, as the LORD commanded Moses.</i> | Aaron did so: he set up its lamps in front of the lampstand, as the LORD commanded Moses. |
| 4 | <i>And this work of the candlestick was of beaten gold, unto the shaft thereof, unto the flowers thereof, was beaten work: according unto the pattern which the LORD had shewed Moses, so he made the candlestick.</i> | this was the workmanship of the lampstand, hammered work of gold. From its base to its flowers, it was hammered work; according to the pattern that the LORD had shown Moses, so he made the lampstand. |
| 5 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 6 | <i>Take the Levites from among the children of Israel, and cleanse them.</i> | 'Take the Levites from among the people of Israel and cleanse them. |
| 7 | <i>And thus shalt thou do unto them, to cleanse them: Sprinkle water of purifying upon them, and let them shave all their flesh, and let them wash their clothes, and so make themselves clean.</i> | this is what You shall do to them to cleanse them: sprinkle the water of purification on them, and let them shave all their body and wash their clothes and cleanse themselves. |

- 8 *Then let them take a young bullock with his meat offering, even fine flour mingled with oil, and another young bullock shalt thou take for a sin offering.* Then let them take a bull from the herd and its grain offering of fine flour mixed with oil, and You shall take another bull from the herd for a sin offering.
- 9 *And thou shalt bring the Levites before the tabernacle of the congregation: and thou shalt gather the whole assembly of the children of Israel together:* you shall bring the Levites before the tent of meeting and assemble the whole congregation of the people of Israel.
- 10 *And thou shalt bring the Levites before the LORD: and the children of Israel shall put their hands upon the Levites:* When You bring the Levites before the LORD, the people of Israel shall lay their hands on the Levites,
- 11 *And Aaron shall offer the Levites before the LORD for an offering of the children of Israel, that they may execute the service of the LORD.* Aaron shall offer the Levites before the LORD as a wave offering from the people of Israel, that they may do the service of the LORD.
- 12 *And the Levites shall lay their hands upon the heads of the bullocks: and thou shalt offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, unto the LORD, to make an atonement for the Levites.* Then the Levites shall lay their hands on the heads of the bulls, and You shall offer the one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering to the LORD to make atonement for the Levites.
- 13 *And thou shalt set the Levites before Aaron, and before his sons, and offer them for an offering unto the LORD.* you shall set the Levites before Aaron and his sons, and shall offer them as a wave offering to the LORD.
- 14 *Thus shalt thou separate the Levites from among the children of Israel: and the Levites shall be mine.* Thus You shall separate the Levites from among the people of Israel, and the Levites shall be mine.
- 15 *And after that shall the Levites go in to do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation: and thou shalt cleanse them, and offer them for an offering.* after that the Levites shall go in to serve at the tent of meeting, when You have cleansed them and offered them as a wave offering.

- 16 *For they are wholly given unto me from among the children of Israel; instead of such as open every womb, even instead of the firstborn of all the children of Israel, have I taken them unto me.* For they are wholly given to me from among the people of Israel. Instead of all who open the womb, the firstborn of all the people of Israel, I have taken them for myself.
- 17 *For all the firstborn of the children of Israel are mine, both man and beast: on the day that I smote every firstborn in the land of Egypt I sanctified them for myself.* For all the firstborn among the people of Israel are mine, both of man and of beast. On the day that I struck down all the firstborn in the land of Egypt I consecrated them for myself,
- 18 *And I have taken the Levites for all the firstborn of the children of Israel.* I have taken the Levites instead of all the firstborn of the people of Israel.
- 19 *And I have given the Levites as a gift to Aaron and to his sons from among the children of Israel, to do the service of the children of Israel in the tabernacle of the congregation, and to make an atonement for the children of Israel: that there be no plague among the children of Israel, when the children of Israel come nigh unto the sanctuary.* I have given the Levites as a gift to Aaron and his sons from among the people of Israel, to do the service for the people of Israel at the tent of meeting and to make atonement for the people of Israel, that there may be no plague among the people of Israel when the people of Israel come near the sanctuary.'
- 20 *And Moses, and Aaron, and all the congregation of the children of Israel, did to the Levites according unto all that the LORD commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so did the children of Israel unto them.* Thus Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the people of Israel did to the Levites. According to all that the LORD commanded Moses concerning the Levites, the people of Israel did to them.
- 21 *And the Levites were purified, and they washed their clothes; and Aaron offered them as an offering before the LORD; and Aaron made an atonement for them to cleanse them.* the Levites purified themselves from sin and washed their clothes, and Aaron offered them as a wave offering before the LORD, and Aaron made atonement for them to cleanse them.

22	<i>And after that went the Levites in to do their service in the tabernacle of the congregation before Aaron, and before his sons: as the LORD had commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so did they unto them.</i>	after that the Levites went in to do their service in the tent of meeting before Aaron and his sons; as the LORD had commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so they did to them.
23	<i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i>	the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
24	<i>This is it that belongeth unto the Levites: from twenty and five years old and upward they shall go in to wait upon the service of the tabernacle of the congregation:</i>	'This applies to the Levites: from twenty-five years old and upward they shall come to do duty in the service of the tent of meeting.
25	<i>And from the age of fifty years they shall cease waiting upon the service thereof, and shall serve no more:</i>	from the age of fifty years they shall withdraw from the duty of the service and serve no more.
26	<i>But shall minister with their brethren in the tabernacle of the congregation, to keep the charge, and shall do no service. Thus shalt thou do unto the Levites touching their charge.</i>	They minister to their brothers in the tent of meeting by keeping guard. But They shall do no service. Thus shall You do to the Levites in assigning their duties.'

Words in this chapter:

- burnt offering** — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.
- sanctuary** — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.
- sin offering** — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.
- candlestick** — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.
- meat** — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.
- Aaron** (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 25:37

v8 — Lev 2:1

v9 — Lev 8:3; Ex 40:12

v12 — Heb 10:4-10; Ex 29:10

v16 — Num 3:12; Num 3:45

v17 — Ex 13:2

v19 — Num 1:53

v21 — Num 8:7

v24 — Num 4:3; 1 Chr 23:3

Chapter 9

The LORD commands Israel to keep the Passover in the wilderness of Sinai, and provides for those who are unclean or on a journey to keep it one month later. The cloud of the LORD covers the tabernacle, and whenever it lifts the people set out; whenever it settles, they camp.

- 1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the first month of the second year after they were come out of the land of Egypt, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the first month of the second year after they had come out of the land of Egypt, saying,
- 2 *Let the children of Israel also keep the passover at his appointed season.* 'Let the people of Israel keep the Passover at its appointed time.
- 3 *In the fourteenth day of this month, at even, ye shall keep it in his appointed season: according to all the rites of it, and according to all the ceremonies thereof, shall ye keep it.* On the fourteenth day of this month, at twilight, You shall keep it at its appointed time; according to all its statutes and all its rules You shall keep it.'
- 4 *And Moses spake unto the children of Israel, that they should keep the passover.* So Moses told the people of Israel that they should keep the Passover.
- 5 *And they kept the passover on the fourteenth day of the first month at even in the wilderness of Sinai: according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did the children of Israel.* they kept the Passover in the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, at twilight, in the wilderness of Sinai; according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so the people of Israel did.

- 6 *And there were certain men, who were defiled by the dead body of a man, that they could not keep the passover on that day: and they came before Moses and before Aaron on that day:* there were certain people who were unclean through touching a human corpse, so that they could not keep the Passover on that day. They came before Moses and Aaron on that day.
- 7 *And those men said unto him, We are defiled by the dead body of a man: wherefore are we kept back, that we may not offer an offering of the LORD in his appointed season among the children of Israel?* those men said to Him, 'We are unclean through touching a human corpse. Why are we kept from bringing the LORD's offering at its appointed time among the people of Israel?'
- 8 *And Moses said unto them, Stand still, and I will hear what the LORD will command concerning you.* Moses said to them, 'Wait, that I may hear what the LORD will command concerning You.'
- 9 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 10 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, If any man of you or of your posterity shall be unclean by reason of a dead body, or be in a journey afar off, yet he shall keep the passover unto the LORD.* 'Speak to the people of Israel, saying, If any one of you or of Your descendants is unclean through touching a dead body, or is on a long journey, He shall still keep the Passover to the LORD.
- 11 *The fourteenth day of the second month at even they shall keep it, and eat it with unleavened bread and bitter herbs.* In the second month on the fourteenth day at twilight they shall keep it. They shall eat it with unleavened bread and bitter herbs.
- 12 *They shall leave none of it unto the morning, nor break any bone of it: according to all the ordinances of the passover they shall keep it.* They shall leave none of it until the morning, nor break any of its bones; according to all the statute for the Passover they shall keep it.

- 13 *But the man that is clean, and is not in a journey, and forbeareth to keep the passover, even the same soul shall be cut off from among his people: because he brought not the offering of the LORD in his appointed season, that man shall bear his sin.* But if a man is clean and is not on a journey, yet refrains from keeping the Passover, that person shall be cut off from His people because He did not bring the LORD's offering at its appointed time; that man shall bear his sin.
- 14 *And if a stranger shall sojourn among you, and will keep the passover unto the LORD; according to the ordinance of the passover, and according to the manner thereof, so shall he do: ye shall have one ordinance, both for the stranger, and for him that was born in the land.* if a stranger sojourns among You and would keep the Passover to the LORD, according to the statute of the Passover and according to its rule, so shall He do. You shall have one statute, both for the sojourner and for the native.'
- 15 *And on the day that the tabernacle was reared up the cloud covered the tabernacle, namely, the tent of the testimony: and at even there was upon the tabernacle as it were the appearance of fire, until the morning.* On the day that the tabernacle was set up, the cloud covered the tabernacle, the tent of the testimony. And at evening it was over the tabernacle like the appearance of fire until morning.
- 16 *So it was alway: the cloud covered it by day, and the appearance of fire by night.* So it was always: the cloud covered it by day and the appearance of fire by night.
- 17 *And when the cloud was taken up from the tabernacle, then after that the children of Israel journeyed: and in the place where the cloud abode, there the children of Israel pitched their tents.* whenever the cloud lifted from over the tent, after that the people of Israel set out, and in the place where the cloud settled down, there the people of Israel camped.

- 18 *At the commandment of the LORD the children of Israel journeyed, and at the commandment of the LORD they pitched: as long as the cloud abode upon the tabernacle they rested in their tents.* At the command of the LORD the people of Israel set out, and at the command of the LORD they camped. As long as the cloud rested over the tabernacle, they remained in camp.
- 19 *And when the cloud tarried long upon the tabernacle many days, then the children of Israel kept the charge of the LORD, and journeyed not.* Even when the cloud continued over the tabernacle many days, the people of Israel kept the charge of the LORD and did not set out.
- 20 *And so it was, when the cloud was a few days upon the tabernacle; according to the commandment of the LORD they abode in their tents, and according to the commandment of the LORD they journeyed.* Sometimes the cloud was a few days over the tabernacle, and according to the command of the LORD they remained in camp; then according to the command of the LORD they set out.
- 21 *And so it was, when the cloud abode from even unto the morning, and that the cloud was taken up in the morning, then they journeyed: whether it was by day or by night that the cloud was taken up, they journeyed.* sometimes the cloud remained from evening until morning. And when the cloud lifted in the morning, they set out, or if it continued for a day and a night, when the cloud lifted they set out.
- 22 *Or whether it were two days, or a month, or a year, that the cloud tarried upon the tabernacle, remaining thereon, the children of Israel abode in their tents, and journeyed not: but when it was taken up, they journeyed.* Whether it was two days, or a month, or a longer time, that the cloud continued over the tabernacle, abiding there, the people of Israel remained in camp and did not set out, but when it lifted they set out.

- 23

At the commandment of the LORD they rested in the tents, and at the commandment of the LORD they journeyed: they kept the charge of the LORD, at the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.
- At the command of the LORD they camped, and at the command of the LORD they set out. They kept the charge of the LORD, at the command of the LORD by Moses.

Words in this chapter:

- sojourner** — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.
- passover** — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 1:1
- v2 — Deut 16:1-2; 1 Cor 5:7-8
- v6 — Ex 18:15; Num 27:2
- v12 — John 19:36; Ex 12:46; Ex 12:10; Ex 12:43
- v13 — Ex 12:15; Gen 17:14
- v14 — Ex 12:48-49
- v15 — Ex 13:21; Ex 40:34
- v17 — Ex 40:36-38

Chapter 10

The LORD commands Moses to make two silver trumpets for summoning the congregation and signaling the camps to march. Israel departs from Sinai in formation for the first time, and Moses asks Hobab his father-in-law to come with them as a guide.

- 1

And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
- the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 2

Make thee two trumpets of silver; of a whole piece shalt thou make them: that thou mayest use them for the calling of the assembly, and for the journeying of the camps.
- 'Make two silver trumpets. Of hammered work You shall make them, and You shall use them for summoning the congregation and for breaking camp.

- 3 *And when they shall blow with them, all the assembly shall assemble themselves to thee at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* When both are blown, all the congregation shall gather themselves to You at the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 4 *And if they blow but with one trumpet, then the princes, which are heads of the thousands of Israel, shall gather themselves unto thee.* But if they blow only one, then the chiefs, the heads of the tribes of Israel, shall gather to You.
- 5 *When ye blow an alarm, then the camps that lie on the east parts shall go forward.* When You blow an alarm, the camps that are on the east side shall set out.
- 6 *When ye blow an alarm the second time, then the camps that lie on the south side shall take their journey: they shall blow an alarm for their journeys.* when You blow an alarm the second time, the camps that are on the south side shall set out. An alarm is to be blown whenever they are to set out.
- 7 *But when the congregation is to be gathered together, ye shall blow, but ye shall not sound an alarm.* But when the assembly is to be gathered together, You shall blow a long blast, but You shall not blow an alarm.
- 8 *And the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall blow with the trumpets; and they shall be to you for an ordinance for ever throughout your generations.* the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall blow the trumpets. The trumpets shall be to you for a perpetual statute throughout your generations.
- 9 *And if ye go to war in your land against the enemy that oppresseth you, then ye shall blow an alarm with the trumpets; and ye shall be remembered before the LORD your God, and ye shall be saved from your enemies.* when You go to war in Your land against the adversary who oppresses you, then you shall sound an alarm with the trumpets, that You may be remembered before the LORD Your God, and You shall be saved from Your enemies.

- 10 *Also in the day of your gladness, and in your solemn days, and in the beginnings of your months, ye shall blow with the trumpets over your burnt offerings, and over the sacrifices of your peace offerings; that they may be to you for a memorial before your God: I am the LORD your God.* On the day of Your gladness also, and at Your appointed feasts and at the beginnings of Your months, You shall blow the trumpets over Your burnt offerings and over the sacrifices of Your peace offerings. They shall be a reminder of You before Your God: I am the LORD Your God.'
- 11 *And it came to pass on the twentieth day of the second month, in the second year, that the cloud was taken up from off the tabernacle of the testimony.* In the second year, in the second month, on the twentieth day of the month, the cloud lifted from over the tabernacle of the testimony,
- 12 *And the children of Israel took their journeys out of the wilderness of Sinai; and the cloud rested in the wilderness of Paran.* the people of Israel set out by stages from the wilderness of Sinai. And the cloud settled down in the wilderness of Paran.
- 13 *And they first took their journey according to the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.* They set out for the first time at the command of the LORD by Moses.
- 14 *In the first place went the standard of the camp of the children of Judah according to their armies: and over his host was Nahshon the son of Amminadab.* The standard of the camp of the people of Judah set out first by their companies, and over their company was Nahshon the son of Amminadab.
- 15 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Issachar was Nethaneel the son of Zuar.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Issachar was Nethanel the son of Zuar.
- 16 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Zebulun was Eliab the son of Helon.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Zebulun was Eliab the son of Helon.

- 17 *And the tabernacle was taken down; and the sons of Gershon and the sons of Merari set forward, bearing the tabernacle.* when the tabernacle was taken down, the sons of Gershon and the sons of Merari, who carried the tabernacle, set out.
- 18 *And the standard of the camp of Reuben set forward according to their armies: and over his host was Elizur the son of Shedeur.* the standard of the camp of Reuben set out by their companies, and over their company was Elizur the son of Shedeur.
- 19 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Simeon was Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Simeon was Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.
- 20 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Gad was Eliasaph the son of Deuel.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Gad was Eliasaph the son of Deuel.
- 21 *And the Kohathites set forward, bearing the sanctuary: and the other did set up the tabernacle against they came.* Then the Kohathites set out, carrying the holy things, and the tabernacle was set up before their arrival.
- 22 *And the standard of the camp of the children of Ephraim set forward according to their armies: and over his host was Elishama the son of Ammihud.* the standard of the camp of the people of Ephraim set out by their companies, and over their company was Elishama the son of Ammihud.
- 23 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Manasseh was Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Manasseh was Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.
- 24 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Benjamin was Abidan the son of Gideoni.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Benjamin was Abidan the son of Gideoni.

- 25 *And the standard of the camp of the children of Dan set forward, which was the rereward of all the camps throughout their hosts: and over his host was Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.* Then the standard of the camp of the people of Dan, acting as the rear guard of all the camps, set out by their companies, and over their company was Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.
- 26 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Asher was Pagiel the son of Ocran.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Asher was Pagiel the son of Ocran.
- 27 *And over the host of the tribe of the children of Naphtali was Ahira the son of Enan.* over the company of the tribe of the people of Naphtali was Ahira the son of Enan.
- 28 *Thus were the journeyings of the children of Israel according to their armies, when they set forward.* This was the order of march of the people of Israel by their companies, when they set out.
- 29 *And Moses said unto Hobab, the son of Raguel the Midianite, Moses' father in law, We are journeying unto the place of which the LORD said, I will give it you: come thou with us, and we will do thee good: for the LORD hath spoken good concerning Israel.* Moses said to Hobab the son of Raguel the Midianite, Moses' father-in-law, 'We are setting out for the place of which the LORD said, "I will give it to You." Come with us. We will do good to You, for the LORD has promised good to Israel.'
- 30 *And he said unto him, I will not go; but I will depart to mine own land, and to my kindred.* But He said to Him, 'I will not go. I will depart to my own land and to my family.'
- 31 *And he said, Leave us not, I pray thee; forasmuch as thou knowest how we are to encamp in the wilderness, and thou mayest be to us instead of eyes.* he said, 'Please do not leave us, for You know where we should camp in the wilderness, and You will serve as eyes for us.
- 32 *And it shall be, if thou go with us, yea, it shall be, that what goodness the LORD shall do unto us, the same will we do unto thee.* if You do go with us, whatever good the LORD will do to us, the same will we do to You.'

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| <p>33 <i>And they departed from the mount of the LORD three days' journey: and the ark of the covenant of the LORD went before them in the three days' journey, to search out a resting place for them.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And the cloud of the LORD was upon them by day, when they went out of the camp.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And it came to pass, when the ark set forward, that Moses said, Rise up, LORD, and let thine enemies be scattered; and let them that hate thee flee before thee.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And when it rested, he said, Return, O LORD, unto the many thousands of Israel.</i></p> | <p>So they set out from the mount of the LORD three days' journey. And the ark of the covenant of the LORD went before them three days' journey, to seek out a resting place for them.</p> <p>the cloud of the LORD was over them by day, whenever they set out from the camp.</p> <p>whenever the ark set out, Moses said, 'Arise, O LORD, and let Your enemies be scattered, and let those who hate You flee before You.'</p> <p>when it rested, He said, 'Return, O LORD, to the ten thousand thousands of Israel.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 4:5
- v4 — Ex 18:21; Num 7:2
- v7 — Joel 2:1
- v9 — 1 Sam 10:18; Judg 2:18; Gen 8:1; Ps 106:4; Ps 106:42
- v10 — Ps 81:3
- v14 — Num 2:3-9
- v18 — Num 2:10-16
- v21 — Num 10:17
- v25 — Josh 6:9
- v29 — Gen 12:7; Judg 4:11; Ex 2:18; Ex 3:1; Ps 34:8
- v31 — Job 29:15
- v35 — Ps 68:1-2

Chapter 11

The people complain about hardship and the LORD's fire burns the outskirts of the camp. They then weep for meat, remembering the food of Egypt; the LORD sends quail in great abundance but strikes the greedy with a severe plague. Moses appoints seventy elders, and the LORD puts His Spirit upon them.

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|---|---|---|
| 1 | <i>And when the people complained, it displeased the LORD: and the LORD heard it; and his anger was kindled; and the fire of the LORD burnt among them, and consumed them that were in the uttermost parts of the camp.</i> | the people complained in the hearing of the LORD about their misfortunes, and when the LORD heard it, His anger was kindled, and the fire of the LORD burned among them and consumed some outlying parts of the camp. |
| 2 | <i>And the people cried unto Moses; and when Moses prayed unto the LORD, the fire was quenched.</i> | Then the people cried out to Moses, and Moses prayed to the LORD, and the fire died out. |
| 3 | <i>And he called the name of that place Taberah: because the fire of the LORD burnt among them.</i> | So the name of that place was called Taberah, because the fire of the LORD burned among them. |
| 4 | <i>And the mixt multitude that was among them fell a lusting: and the children of Israel also wept again, and said, Who shall give us flesh to eat?</i> | Now the mixt multitude that was among them had a strong craving. And the people of Israel also wept again and said, 'Oh that we had meat to eat! |
| 5 | <i>We remember the fish, which we did eat in Egypt freely; the cucumbers, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlick:</i> | We remember the fish we ate in Egypt that cost nothing, the cucumbers, the melons, the leeks, the onions, and the garlic. |
| 6 | <i>But now our soul is dried away: there is nothing at all, beside this manna, before our eyes.</i> | But now our strength is dried up, and there is nothing at all but this manna to look at.' |
| 7 | <i>And the manna was as coriander seed, and the colour thereof as the colour of bdellium.</i> | Now the manna was like coriander seed, and its appearance like that of bdellium. |

- 8 *And the people went about, and gathered it, and ground it in mills, or beat it in a mortar, and baked it in pans, and made cakes of it: and the taste of it was as the taste of fresh oil.* The people went about and gathered it and ground it in hand mills or beat it in mortars and boiled it in pots and made cakes of it. And the taste of it was like the taste of cakes baked with oil.
- 9 *And when the dew fell upon the camp in the night, the manna fell upon it.* When the dew fell upon the camp in the night, the manna fell with it.
- 10 *Then Moses heard the people weep throughout their families, every man in the door of his tent: and the anger of the LORD was kindled greatly; Moses also was displeased.* Moses heard the people weeping throughout their clans, everyone at the door of his tent. And the anger of the LORD blazed hotly, and Moses was displeased.
- 11 *And Moses said unto the LORD, Wherefore hast thou afflicted thy servant? and wherefore have I not found favour in thy sight, that thou layest the burden of all this people upon me?* Moses said to the LORD, 'Why have You dealt ill with Your servant? And why have I not found favor in Your sight, that You lay the burden of all this people on me?
- 12 *Have I conceived all this people? have I begotten them, that thou shouldest say unto me, Carry them in thy bosom, as a nursing father beareth the sucking child, unto the land which thou swarest unto their fathers?* Did I conceive all this people? Did I give them birth, that You should say to me, "Carry them in Your bosom, as a nurse carries a nursing child," to the land that You swore to give their fathers?
- 13 *Whence should I have flesh to give unto all this people? for they weep unto me, saying, Give us flesh, that we may eat.* Where am I to get meat to give to all this people? For they weep before me and say, "Give us meat, that we may eat."
- 14 *I am not able to bear all this people alone, because it is too heavy for me.* I am not able to carry all this people alone; the burden is too heavy for me.
- 15 *And if thou deal thus with me, kill me, I pray thee, out of hand, if I have found favour in thy sight; and let me not see my wretchedness.* If You will treat me like this, kill me at once, if I find favor in Your sight, that I may not see my wretchedness.'

- 16 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Gather unto me seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom thou knowest to be the elders of the people, and officers over them; and bring them unto the tabernacle of the congregation, that they may stand there with thee.* Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Gather for me seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom you know to be the elders of the people and officers over them, and bring them to the tent of meeting, and let them take their stand there with you.
- 17 *And I will come down and talk with thee there: and I will take of the spirit which is upon thee, and will put it upon them; and they shall bear the burden of the people with thee, that thou bear it not thyself alone.* I will come down and talk with You there. And I will take some of the Spirit that is on You and put it on them. They shall bear the burden of the people with you, so that you may not bear it yourself alone.
- 18 *And say thou unto the people, Sanctify yourselves against to morrow, and ye shall eat flesh: for ye have wept in the ears of the LORD, saying, Who shall give us flesh to eat? for it was well with us in Egypt: therefore the LORD will give you flesh, and ye shall eat.* say to the people, "Consecrate yourselves for tomorrow, and You shall eat meat, for You have wept in the hearing of the LORD, saying, 'Who will give us meat to eat? For it was better for us in Egypt.' Therefore the LORD will give You meat, and You shall eat.
- 19 *Ye shall not eat one day, nor two days, nor five days, neither ten days, nor twenty days;* You shall not eat just one day, or two days, or five days, or ten days, or twenty days,
- 20 *But even a whole month, until it come out at your nostrils, and it be loathsome unto you: because that ye have despised the LORD which is among you, and have wept before him, saying, Why came we forth out of Egypt?* but a whole month, until it comes out at Your nostrils and becomes loathsome to You, because You have rejected the LORD Who is among You and have wept before Him, saying, 'Why did we come out of Egypt?'"

- 21 *And Moses said, The people, among whom I am, are six hundred thousand footmen; and thou hast said, I will give them flesh, that they may eat a whole month.* But Moses said, 'The people among whom I am number 600,000 on foot, and you have said, "I will give them meat, that they may eat a whole month!"
- 22 *Shall the flocks and the herds be slain for them, to suffice them? or shall all the fish of the sea be gathered together for them, to suffice them?* Shall flocks and herds be slaughtered for them, and be enough for them? Or shall all the fish of the sea be gathered together for them, and be enough for them?"
- 23 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Is the LORD's hand waxed short? thou shalt see now whether my word shall come to pass unto thee or not.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Is the LORD's hand shortened? Now you shall see whether my word will come true for you or not.'
- 24 *And Moses went out, and told the people the words of the LORD, and gathered the seventy men of the elders of the people, and set them round about the tabernacle.* So Moses went out and told the people the words of the LORD. And He gathered seventy men of the elders of the people and placed them around the tent.
- 25 *And the LORD came down in a cloud, and spake unto him, and took of the spirit that was upon him, and gave it unto the seventy elders: and it came to pass, that, when the spirit rested upon them, they prophesied, and did not cease.* Then the LORD came down in the cloud and spoke to Him, and took some of the Spirit that was on Him and put it on the seventy elders. And as soon as the Spirit rested on them, they prophesied. But they did so no more.
- 26 *But there remained two of the men in the camp, the name of the one was Eldad, and the name of the other Medad: and the spirit rested upon them; and they were of them that were written, but went not out unto the tabernacle: and they prophesied in the camp.* Now two men remained in the camp, one named Eldad, and the other named Medad, and the Spirit rested on them. They were among those registered. But They had not gone out to the tent, and so they prophesied in the camp.

- 27 *And there ran a young man, and told Moses, and said, Eldad and Medad do prophesy in the camp.* a young man ran and told Moses, 'Eldad and Medad are prophesying in the camp.'
- 28 *And Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of Moses, one of his young men, answered and said, My lord Moses, forbid them.* Joshua the son of Nun, the assistant of Moses from his youth, said, 'My lord Moses, stop them.'
- 29 *And Moses said unto him, Enviest thou for my sake? would God that all the LORD's people were prophets, and that the LORD would put his spirit upon them!* But Moses said to him, 'Are you jealous for my sake? Would that all the LORD's people were prophets, that the LORD would put His Spirit on them!'
- 30 *And Moses gat him into the camp, he and the elders of Israel.* Moses and the elders of Israel returned to the camp.
- 31 *And there went forth a wind from the LORD, and brought quails from the sea, and let them fall by the camp, as it were a day's journey on this side, and as it were a day's journey on the other side, round about the camp, and as it were two cubits high upon the face of the earth.* Then a wind from the LORD sprang up and brought quail from the sea and let them fall beside the camp, about a day's journey on this side and a day's journey on the other side, around the camp, and about two cubits above the ground.
- 32 *And the people stood up all that day, and all that night, and all the next day, and they gathered the quails: he that gathered least gathered ten homers: and they spread them all abroad for themselves round about the camp.* the people rose all that day and all night and all the next day, and gathered the quail. Those who gathered least gathered ten homers. And they spread them out for themselves all around the camp.
- 33 *And while the flesh was yet between their teeth, ere it was chewed, the wrath of the LORD was kindled against the people, and the LORD smote the people with a very great plague.* While the meat was yet between their teeth, before it was consumed, the anger of the LORD was kindled against the people. The LORD struck down the people with a very great plague.

34	<i>And he called the name of that place Kibrothhattaavah: because there they buried the people that lusted.</i>	Therefore the name of that place was called Kibroth-hattaavah, because there they buried the people who had the craving.
35	<i>And the people journeyed from Kibrothhattaavah unto Hazeroth; and abode at Hazeroth.</i>	From Kibroth-hattaavah the people journeyed to Hazeroth. They remained at Hazeroth.

Words in this chapter:

- bdellium** (*DEL-ee-um*) — A fragrant resin or precious stone mentioned in Genesis 2:12 and Numbers 11:7 — its exact identity is uncertain; likely a translucent gum-resin.
- mixt multitude** — A crowd of non-Israelites who joined the Exodus from Egypt — probably slaves and foreigners who left with Israel and often caused trouble.
- Joshua** (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Num 21:5; 2 Kgs 1:12; Num 16:35; Ex 16:9; Lev 10:2
- v2** — Num 21:7
- v4** — 1 Cor 10:6; Ex 12:38; Ps 106:14; Ps 78:18-20; Neh 13:3
- v12** — Isa 49:23; Isa 40:11; Ex 13:5; 1 Thess 2:7
- v14** — Ex 18:18
- v16** — Ex 24:1; Ex 24:9; Deut 16:18; Deut 1:15; Luke 10:17
- v17** — 1 Sam 10:6; Num 11:25; 1 Cor 2:12; 1 Cor 12:4-11; 2 Kgs 2:9
- v23** — Gen 18:14; Isa 59:1; Isa 50:2; Matt 19:26; Luke 1:37
- v25** — Num 11:17; Joel 2:28-29
- v29** — 1 Cor 14:5; Matt 9:37-38; Jas 5:9; Jas 4:5; Luke 10:2
- v31** — Ex 16:13; Ps 105:40
- v33** — Ps 78:30-31; Ps 106:14-15

Chapter 12

Miriam and Aaron speak against Moses because of his Ethiopian wife and challenge his unique authority. The LORD rebukes them, declaring that He speaks with Moses face to face, and strikes Miriam with leprosy; she is shut outside the camp seven days before being healed.

1	<i>And Miriam and Aaron spake against Moses because of the Ethiopian woman whom he had married: for he had married an Ethiopian woman.</i>	Miriam and Aaron spoke against Moses because of the Ethiopian woman whom he had married, for he had married an Ethiopian woman.
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- 2 *And they said, Hath the LORD indeed spoken only by Moses? hath he not spoken also by us? And the LORD heard it.* they said, 'Has the LORD indeed spoken only through Moses? Has he not spoken through us also?' And the LORD heard it.
- 3 *(Now the man Moses was very meek, above all the men which were upon the face of the earth.)* Now the man Moses was very meek, more than all people who were on the face of the earth.
- 4 *And the LORD spake suddenly unto Moses, and unto Aaron, and unto Miriam, Come out ye three unto the tabernacle of the congregation. And they three came out.* suddenly the LORD said to Moses and to Aaron and Miriam, 'Come out, you three, to the tent of meeting.' And the three of them came out.
- 5 *And the LORD came down in the pillar of the cloud, and stood in the door of the tabernacle, and called Aaron and Miriam: and they both came forth.* the LORD came down in a pillar of cloud and stood at the entrance of the tent and called Aaron and Miriam. They both came forward.
- 6 *And he said, Hear now my words: If there be a prophet among you, I the LORD will make myself known unto him in a vision, and will speak unto him in a dream.* he said, 'Hear my words: If there is a prophet among You, I the LORD make myself known to Him in a vision; I speak with Him in a dream.
- 7 *My servant Moses is not so, who is faithful in all mine house.* Not so with my servant Moses. He is faithful in all my house.
- 8 *With him will I speak mouth to mouth, even apparently, and not in dark speeches; and the similitude of the LORD shall he behold: wherefore then were ye not afraid to speak against my servant Moses?* With Him I speak mouth to mouth, clearly, and not in riddles. He beholds the form of the LORD. Why then were You not afraid to speak against my servant Moses?'
- 9 *And the anger of the LORD was kindled against them; and he departed.* the anger of the LORD was kindled against them. He departed.

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| <p>10 <i>And the cloud departed from off the tabernacle; and, behold, Miriam became leprous, white as snow: and Aaron looked upon Miriam, and, behold, she was leprous.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Aaron said unto Moses, Alas, my lord, I beseech thee, lay not the sin upon us, wherein we have done foolishly, and wherein we have sinned.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Let her not be as one dead, of whom the flesh is half consumed when he cometh out of his mother's womb.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And Moses cried unto the LORD, saying, Heal her now, O God, I beseech thee.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, If her father had but spit in her face, should she not be ashamed seven days? let her be shut out from the camp seven days, and after that let her be received in again.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Miriam was shut out from the camp seven days: and the people journeyed not till Miriam was brought in again.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And afterward the people removed from Hazeroth, and pitched in the wilderness of Paran.</i></p> | <p>When the cloud removed from over the tent, Miriam was leprous, like snow. And Aaron turned toward Miriam. She was leprous.</p> <p>Aaron said to Moses, 'Oh, my lord, do not punish us because we have done foolishly and have sinned.</p> <p>Let her not be as one dead, whose flesh is half eaten away when he comes out of his mother's womb.'</p> <p>Moses cried to the LORD, 'O God, please heal her — please.'</p> <p>But the LORD said to Moses, 'If her father had but spit in her face, should she not be shamed seven days? Let her be shut outside the camp seven days, and after that she may be brought in again.'</p> <p>So Miriam was shut outside the camp seven days, and the people did not set out on the march until Miriam was brought in again.</p> <p>After that the people set out from Hazeroth, and camped in the wilderness of Paran.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Miriam (*MEER-ee-am*) — Moses and Aaron's older sister — led the women in song after the Red Sea crossing; later struck with leprosy for challenging Moses's authority.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ex 2:21; Gen 26:34-35
v2 — Num 16:3; Ezek 35:12-13; Isa 37:4; Phil 2:3; Phil 2:14
v3 — Matt 11:29; Jas 3:13; Matt 5:5; 2 Cor 12:11; 2 Cor 11:5
v5 — Num 11:25; Ex 34:5
v6 — 1 Kgs 3:5; Gen 31:10-11; Gen 46:2; Acts 22:17-18; Luke 1:22
v7 — Heb 3:2-6
v8 — Deut 34:10; 1 Cor 13:12; Ex 33:11; Ex 33:23; Ex 24:10-11
v10 — Deut 24:9; 2 Kgs 5:27
v11 — 2 Sam 24:10; 2 Sam 19:19
v12 — Ps 88:4-5
v13 — Luke 6:28; Jas 5:15; Rom 12:21
v14 — Deut 25:9; Job 30:10; Isa 50:6

Chapter 13

The LORD commands Moses to send twelve spies, one from each tribe, to scout the land of Canaan. After forty days they return with grapes, pomegranates, and figs, but ten of the spies give a fearful report, saying the inhabitants are giants and the land devours its people; only Caleb and Joshua urge Israel to go up.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses,</i></p> | <p>the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Send thou men, that they may search the land of Canaan, which I give unto the children of Israel: of every tribe of their fathers shall ye send a man, every one a ruler among them.</i></p> | <p>'Send men to spy out the land of Canaan, which I am giving to the people of Israel. From each tribe of their fathers You shall send a man, every one a chief among them.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Moses by the commandment of the LORD sent them from the wilderness of Paran: all those men were heads of the children of Israel.</i></p> | <p>So Moses sent them from the wilderness of Paran, according to the command of the LORD, all of them men who were heads of the people of Israel.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And these were their names: of the tribe of Reuben, Shammua the son of Zaccur.</i></p> | <p>these were their names: From the tribe of Reuben, Shammua the son of Zaccur;</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Of the tribe of Simeon, Shaphat the son of Hori.</i></p> | <p>from the tribe of Simeon, Shaphat the son of Hori;</p> |

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| 6 | <i>Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh.</i> | from the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh; |
| 7 | <i>Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph.</i> | from the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph; |
| 8 | <i>Of the tribe of Ephraim, Oshea the son of Nun.</i> | from the tribe of Ephraim, Oshea the son of Nun; |
| 9 | <i>Of the tribe of Benjamin, Palti the son of Raphu.</i> | from the tribe of Benjamin, Palti the son of Raphu; |
| 10 | <i>Of the tribe of Zebulun, Gaddiel the son of Sodi.</i> | from the tribe of Zebulun, Gaddiel the son of Sodi; |
| 11 | <i>Of the tribe of Joseph, namely, of the tribe of Manasseh, Gaddi the son of Susi.</i> | from the tribe of Joseph, that is, from the tribe of Manasseh, Gaddi the son of Susi; |
| 12 | <i>Of the tribe of Dan, Ammiel the son of Gemalli.</i> | from the tribe of Dan, Ammiel the son of Gemalli; |
| 13 | <i>Of the tribe of Asher, Sethur the son of Michael.</i> | from the tribe of Asher, Sethur the son of Michael; |
| 14 | <i>Of the tribe of Naphtali, Nahbi the son of Vophsi.</i> | from the tribe of Naphtali, Nahbi the son of Vophsi; |
| 15 | <i>Of the tribe of Gad, Geuel the son of Machi.</i> | from the tribe of Gad, Geuel the son of Machi. |
| 16 | <i>These are the names of the men which Moses sent to spy out the land. And Moses called Oshea the son of Nun Jehoshua.</i> | These were the names of the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land. And Moses called Oshea the son of Nun Jehoshua. |
| 17 | <i>And Moses sent them to spy out the land of Canaan, and said unto them, Get you up this way southward, and go up into the mountain:</i> | Moses sent them to spy out the land of Canaan and said to them, 'Go up this way into the south and go up into the hill country, |
| 18 | <i>And see the land, what it is; and the people that dwelleth therein, whether they be strong or weak, few or many;</i> | see what the land is, and whether the people who dwell in it are strong or weak, whether they are few or many, |

- 19 *And what the land is that they dwell in, whether it be good or bad; and what cities they be that they dwell in, whether in tents, or in strong holds;* whether the land that they dwell in is good or bad, and whether the cities that they dwell in are camps or strongholds,
- 20 *And what the land is, whether it be fat or lean, whether there be wood therein, or not. And be ye of good courage, and bring of the fruit of the land. Now the time was the time of the firstripe grapes.* whether the land is rich or poor, and whether there are trees in it or not. Be of good courage and bring some of the fruit of the land.' Now the time was the season of the first ripe grapes.
- 21 *So they went up, and searched the land from the wilderness of Zin unto Rehob, as men come to Hamath.* So they went up and spied out the land from the wilderness of Zin to Rehob, as men come to Hamath.
- 22 *And they ascended by the south, and came unto Hebron; where Ahiman, Sheshai, and Talmi, the children of Anak, were. (Now Hebron was built seven years before Zoan in Egypt.)* They went up into the south, and came to Hebron. Ahiman, Sheshai, and Talmi, the descendants of Anak, were there. Hebron was built seven years before Zoan in Egypt.
- 23 *And they came unto the brook of Eshcol, and cut down from thence a branch with one cluster of grapes, and they bare it between two upon a staff; and they brought of the pomegranates, and of the figs.* they came to the Valley of Eshcol and cut down from there a branch with a single cluster of grapes. They carried it on a pole between two of them; they also brought some pomegranates and figs.
- 24 *The place was called the brook Eshcol, because of the cluster of grapes which the children of Israel cut down from thence.* That place was called the Valley of Eshcol, because of the cluster that the people of Israel cut down from there.
- 25 *And they returned from searching of the land after forty days.* At the end of forty days they returned from spying out the land.

- 26 *And they went and came to Moses, and to Aaron, and to all the congregation of the children of Israel, unto the wilderness of Paran, to Kadesh; and brought back word unto them, and unto all the congregation, and shewed them the fruit of the land.* they came to Moses and Aaron and to all the congregation of the people of Israel in the wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh. They brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land.
- 27 *And they told him, and said, We came unto the land whither thou sentest us, and surely it floweth with milk and honey; and this is the fruit of it.* they told him, 'We came to the land to which you sent us. It flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit.
- 28 *Nevertheless the people be strong that dwell in the land, and the cities are walled, and very great: and moreover we saw the children of Anak there.* However, the people who dwell in the land are strong, and the cities are fortified and very large. And besides, we saw the descendants of Anak there.
- 29 *The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south: and the Hittites, and the Jebusites, and the Amorites, dwell in the mountains: and the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and by the coast of Jordan.* The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south. The Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites dwell in the hill country. And the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and along the Jordan.'
- 30 *And Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.* But Caleb quieted the people before Moses and said, 'Let us go up at once and occupy it, for we are well able to overcome it.'
- 31 *But the men that went up with him said, We be not able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we.* Then the men who had gone up with him said, 'We are not able to go up against the people, for they are stronger than we are.'

- 32 *And they brought up an evil report of the land which they had searched unto the children of Israel, saying, The land, through which we have gone to search it, is a land that eateth up the inhabitants thereof; and all the people that we saw in it are men of a great stature.* So they brought to the people of Israel a bad report of the land that they had spied out, saying, "The land, through which we have gone to spy it out, is a land that devours its inhabitants. All the people that we saw in it are of great height.
- 33 *And there we saw the giants, the sons of Anak, which come of the giants: and we were in our own sight as grasshoppers, and so we were in their sight.* there we saw the giants, the sons of Anak, who come from the giants. We seemed to ourselves like grasshoppers, and so we seemed to them.'

Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

v2 — Deut 1:22-25; Num 32:8

v6 — Num 34:19; Num 14:6

v17 — Judg 1:9

v20 — Deut 31:23

v21 — Num 33:36; Num 20:1; Num 27:14

v22 — Ps 78:43; Ps 78:12

v27 — Ex 3:8; Ex 13:5; Ex 3:17; Ex 33:3

v28 — Deut 9:1-2; Deut 1:28

v30 — Num 14:24; Rom 8:31; Phil 4:13; Ps 60:12; Num 14:6-9

v31 — Deut 1:28; Josh 14:8; Heb 3:19; Num 32:9

v32 — Amos 2:9; Num 14:36-37

v33 — Deut 1:28; Gen 6:4; Isa 40:22; Deut 9:2; 1 Sam 17:42

Chapter 14

The people weep, rebel, and threaten to choose a new leader to return to Egypt. The LORD threatens to destroy them, but Moses intercedes; God pardons the nation but decrees that the entire adult generation except Caleb and Joshua will die in the wilderness over forty years. The people then presumptuously try to invade Canaan and are defeated.

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| 1 | <i>And all the congregation lifted up their voice, and cried; and the people wept that night.</i> | Then all the congregation raised a loud cry, and the people wept that night. |
| 2 | <i>And all the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron: and the whole congregation said unto them, Would God that we had died in the land of Egypt! or would God we had died in this wilderness!</i> | All the people of Israel grumbled against Moses and Aaron. The whole congregation said to them, 'If only we had died in the land of Egypt! Or if only we had died in this wilderness! |
| 3 | <i>And wherefore hath the LORD brought us unto this land, to fall by the sword, that our wives and our children should be a prey? were it not better for us to return into Egypt?</i> | Why is the LORD bringing us into this land, to fall by the sword? Our wives and our little ones will become plunder. Would it not be better for us to go back to Egypt?' |
| 4 | <i>And they said one to another, Let us make a captain, and let us return into Egypt.</i> | they said to one another, 'Let us choose a leader and go back to Egypt.' |
| 5 | <i>Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel.</i> | Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the people of Israel. |

- 6 *And Joshua the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, which were of them that searched the land, rent their clothes:* Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were among those who had spied out the land, tore their clothes
- 7 *And they spake unto all the company of the children of Israel, saying, The land, which we passed through to search it, is an exceeding good land.* said to all the congregation of the people of Israel, 'The land, which we passed through to spy it out, is an greatly good land.
- 8 *If the LORD delight in us, then he will bring us into this land, and give it us; a land which floweth with milk and honey.* If the LORD delights in us, He will bring us into this land and give it to us, a land that flows with milk and honey.
- 9 *Only rebel not ye against the LORD, neither fear ye the people of the land; for they are bread for us: their defence is departed from them, and the LORD is with us: fear them not.* Only do not rebel against the LORD. And do not fear the people of the land, for they are our prey. Their protection has been removed from them. The LORD is with us. Do not fear them.'
- 10 *But all the congregation bade stone them with stones. And the glory of the LORD appeared in the tabernacle of the congregation before all the children of Israel.* But all the congregation said to stone them with stones. Then the glory of the LORD appeared at the tent of meeting to all the people of Israel.
- 11 *And the LORD said unto Moses, How long will this people provoke me? and how long will it be ere they believe me, for all the signs which I have shewed among them?* the LORD said to Moses, 'How long will this people despise me? And how long will they not believe in me, in spite of all the signs that I have done among them?
- 12 *I will smite them with the pestilence, and disinherit them, and will make of thee a greater nation and mightier than they.* I will strike them with pestilence and disinherit them. I will make of You a nation greater and mightier than they.'
- 13 *And Moses said unto the LORD, Then the Egyptians shall hear it, (for thou broughtest up this people in thy might from among them;)* But Moses said to the LORD, 'Then the Egyptians will hear of it, for You brought up this people in Your might from among them,

- 14 *And they will tell it to the inhabitants of this land: for they have heard that thou LORD art among this people, that thou LORD art seen face to face, and that thy cloud standeth over them, and that thou goest before them, by day time in a pillar of a cloud, and in a pillar of fire by night.* they will tell it to the inhabitants of this land. They have heard that You, O LORD, are in the midst of this people. For You, O LORD, are seen face to face, and Your cloud stands over them and You go before them, in a pillar of cloud by day and in a pillar of fire by night.
- 15 *Now if thou shalt kill all this people as one man, then the nations which have heard the fame of thee will speak, saying,* Now if You kill this people as one man, then the nations who have heard your fame will say,
- 16 *Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land which he sware unto them, therefore he hath slain them in the wilderness.* "Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land that He swore to give them, He has slaughtered them in the wilderness."
- 17 *And now, I beseech thee, let the power of my Lord be great, according as thou hast spoken, saying,* now, please let the power of the Lord be great as You have promised, saying,
- 18 *The LORD is longsuffering, and of great mercy, forgiving iniquity and transgression, and by no means clearing the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation.* "The LORD is longsuffering and abounding in mercy, forgiving iniquity and transgression. But He will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, to the third and the fourth generation."
- 19 *Pardon, I beseech thee, the iniquity of this people according unto the greatness of thy mercy, and as thou hast forgiven this people, from Egypt even until now.* Please pardon the iniquity of this people, according to the greatness of Your mercy, just as You have forgiven this people, from Egypt until now.'
- 20 *And the LORD said, I have pardoned according to thy word:* Then the LORD said, 'I have pardoned, according to Your word.

- 21 *But as truly as I live, all the earth shall be filled with the glory of the LORD.* But truly, as I live, and as all the earth shall be filled with the glory of the LORD,
- 22 *Because all those men which have seen my glory, and my miracles, which I did in Egypt and in the wilderness, and have tempted me now these ten times, and have not hearkened to my voice;* none of the men who have seen my glory and my signs that I did in Egypt and in the wilderness, and yet have put me to the test these ten times and have not obeyed my voice,
- 23 *Surely they shall not see the land which I swear unto their fathers, neither shall any of them that provoked me see it:* shall see the land that I swore to give to their fathers. None of those who despised me shall see it.
- 24 *But my servant Caleb, because he had another spirit with him, and hath followed me fully, him will I bring into the land whereinto he went; and his seed shall possess it.* But my servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit and has followed me fully, I will bring into the land into which he went. His descendants shall possess it.
- 25 *(Now the Amalekites and the Canaanites dwelt in the valley.) To morrow turn you, and get you into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea.* Now the Amalekites and the Canaanites dwell in the valleys. Turn tomorrow and set out for the wilderness by the way of the Red Sea.'
- 26 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying,
- 27 *How long shall I bear with this evil congregation, which murmur against me? I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against me.* 'How long shall this wicked congregation grumble against me? I have heard the grumblings of the people of Israel, which they grumble against me.
- 28 *Say unto them, As truly as I live, saith the LORD, as ye have spoken in mine ears, so will I do to you:* Say to them, "As I live," declares the LORD, "what You have said in my hearing I will do to You:

- 29 *Your carcasses shall fall in this wilderness; and all that were numbered of you, according to your whole number, from twenty years old and upward, which have murmured against me,* your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness, and of all Your number, listed in the census from twenty years old and upward, who have grumbled against me,
- 30 *Doubtless ye shall not come into the land, concerning which I sware to make you dwell therein, save Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.* not one shall come into the land where I swore that I would make you dwell, except Caleb the son of Jephunneh and Joshua the son of Nun.
- 31 *But your little ones, which ye said should be a prey, them will I bring in, and they shall know the land which ye have despised.* But your little ones, who you said would become plunder, I will bring in. They shall know the land that you have rejected.
- 32 *But as for you, your carcasses, they shall fall in this wilderness.* But as for you, your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness.
- 33 *And your children shall wander in the wilderness forty years, and bear your whoredoms, until your carcasses be wasted in the wilderness.* your children shall wander in the wilderness forty years and shall bear your whoredoms, until the last of your dead bodies lies in the wilderness.
- 34 *After the number of the days in which ye searched the land, even forty days, each day for a year, shall ye bear your iniquities, even forty years, and ye shall know my breach of promise.* According to the number of the days in which you spied out the land, forty days, a year for each day, you shall bear your iniquity forty years, and you shall know my displeasure.
- 35 *I the LORD have said, I will surely do it unto all this evil congregation, that are gathered together against me: in this wilderness they shall be consumed, and there they shall die.* I, the LORD, have spoken. Surely this will I do to all this wicked congregation who are gathered together against me: in this wilderness they shall come to a full end, and there they shall die."

- 36 *And the men, which Moses sent to search the land, who returned, and made all the congregation to murmur against him, by bringing up a slander upon the land,* the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the congregation grumble against him by bringing up a bad report about the land—
- 37 *Even those men that did bring up the evil report upon the land, died by the plague before the LORD.* those men who brought up a bad report of the land died by plague before the LORD.
- 38 *But Joshua the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, which were of the men that went to search the land, lived still.* Of those men who went to spy out the land, only Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh remained alive.
- 39 *And Moses told these sayings unto all the children of Israel: and the people mourned greatly.* When Moses told these words to all the people of Israel, the people mourned greatly.
- 40 *And they rose up early in the morning, and gat them up into the top of the mountain, saying, Lo, we be here, and will go up unto the place which the LORD hath promised: for we have sinned.* they rose early in the morning and went up to the heights of the hill country, saying, 'Here we are. We will go up to the place that the LORD has promised, for we have sinned.'
- 41 *And Moses said, Wherefore now do ye transgress the commandment of the LORD? but it shall not prosper.* But Moses said, 'Why are you transgressing the command of the LORD? For that will not succeed.
- 42 *Go not up, for the LORD is not among you; that ye be not smitten before your enemies.* Do not go up, for the LORD is not among You, lest You be struck down before Your enemies.
- 43 *For the Amalekites and the Canaanites are there before you, and ye shall fall by the sword: because ye are turned away from the LORD, therefore the LORD will not be with you.* For the Amalekites and the Canaanites are there before You, and You shall fall by the sword. Because You have turned back from the LORD, the LORD will not be with You.'

44	<i>But they presumed to go up unto the hill top: nevertheless the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and Moses, departed not out of the camp.</i>	But they presumed to go up to the heights of the hill country, even though the ark of the covenant of the LORD and Moses did not depart out of the camp.
45	<i>Then the Amalekites came down, and the Canaanites which dwelt in that hill, and smote them, and discomfited them, even unto Hormah.</i>	Then the Amalekites and the Canaanites who lived in that hill country came down and defeated them, pursuing them to Hormah.

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Num 16:4; Num 16:22; Num 16:45
- v8 — 2 Sam 22:20; Isa 62:4; Num 13:27; Deut 10:15; Ps 147:10-11
- v9 — Deut 7:18; Rom 8:31; Deut 31:6; Ps 74:14; 2 Chr 32:8
- v10 — Ex 17:4; 1 Sam 30:6; Lev 9:23
- v11 — Ps 78:32; Ps 106:24; Ps 78:22; Ps 78:41-42; Deut 9:22-23
- v13 — Ps 106:23; Ezek 20:9; Deut 32:27; Ex 32:11-14
- v18 — Ex 34:6-7; Ps 145:8; Ex 20:5; Jonah 4:2; Nah 1:2-3
- v19 — Ex 34:9; Ps 78:38; Ps 106:45
- v21 — Hab 2:14; Ps 72:19; Isa 6:3
- v24 — Josh 14:6-14; Num 14:6-9; Acts 11:23; Num 32:11-12; Eph 6:6
- v34 — Ezek 4:6; Num 13:25; Jer 18:9-10
- v45 — Num 21:3; Judg 1:17; Deut 1:44

Chapter 15

The LORD gives additional laws concerning grain and drink offerings that must accompany animal sacrifices in the Promised Land. He commands the wearing of fringes with a blue cord on their garments as a reminder to keep His commandments, and a man found gathering sticks on the Sabbath is stoned to death by the congregation.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
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- 2 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye be come into the land of your habitations, which I give unto you,* 'Speak to the people of Israel and say to them, when you come into the land You are to inhabit, which I am giving You,
- 3 *And will make an offering by fire unto the LORD, a burnt offering, or a sacrifice in performing a vow, or in a freewill offering, or in your solemn feasts, to make a sweet savour unto the LORD, of the herd, or of the flock:* you offer to the LORD a offering made by fire from the herd or from the flock — whether a burnt offering or a sacrifice, to fulfill a vow or as a freewill offering or at Your appointed feasts — to make a sweet savour unto the LORD,
- 4 *Then shall he that offereth his offering unto the LORD bring a meat offering of a tenth deal of flour mingled with the fourth part of an hin of oil.* then He who brings his offering shall offer to the LORD a grain offering of a tenth of an ephah of fine flour, mixed with a quarter of a hin of oil;
- 5 *And the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering shalt thou prepare with the burnt offering or sacrifice, for one lamb.* you shall offer with the burnt offering, or for the sacrifice, a quarter of a hin of wine as a drink offering for each lamb.
- 6 *Or for a ram, thou shalt prepare for a meat offering two tenth deals of flour mingled with the third part of an hin of oil.* Or for a ram, You shall offer a grain offering of two tenths of an ephah of fine flour, mixed with a third of a hin of oil.
- 7 *And for a drink offering thou shalt offer the third part of an hin of wine, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.* for a drink offering You shall offer a third of a hin of wine, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 8 *And when thou preparest a bullock for a burnt offering, or for a sacrifice in performing a vow, or peace offerings unto the LORD:* when You offer a bull as a burnt offering or sacrifice, to fulfill a vow or for peace offerings to the LORD,
- 9 *Then shall he bring with a bullock a meat offering of three tenth deals of flour mingled with half an hin of oil.* then You shall offer with the bull a grain offering of three tenths of an ephah of fine flour, mixed with half a hin of oil.

- 10 *And thou shalt bring for a drink offering half an hin of wine, for an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* you shall offer for the drink offering half a hin of wine, as a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 11 *Thus shall it be done for one bullock, or for one ram, or for a lamb, or a kid.* Thus it shall be done for each bull or ram, or for each of the male lambs or the young goats.
- 12 *According to the number that ye shall prepare, so shall ye do to every one according to their number.* According to the number that You offer, so shall You do for each one, according to their number.
- 13 *All that are born of the country shall do these things after this manner, in offering an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* Every native Israelite shall do these things in this way, in offering a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 14 *And if a stranger sojourn with you, or whosoever be among you in your generations, and will offer an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD; as ye do, so he shall do.* if a stranger is sojourning with You, or anyone is living among you throughout your generations. He wishes to offer a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD, He shall do as You do.
- 15 *One ordinance shall be both for you of the congregation, and also for the stranger that sojourneth with you, an ordinance for ever in your generations: as ye are, so shall the stranger be before the LORD.* For the assembly, there shall be one statute for You and for the stranger who sojourns with You, a statute forever throughout Your generations. You and the sojourner shall be alike before the LORD.
- 16 *One law and one manner shall be for you, and for the stranger that sojourneth with you.* One law and one rule shall be for You and for the stranger who sojourns with You.'
- 17 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 18 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye come into the land whither I bring you,* 'Speak to the people of Israel and say to them, when you come into the land to which I am bringing You

- 19 *Then it shall be, that, when ye eat of the bread of the land, ye shall offer up an heave offering unto the LORD.* when You eat of the bread of the land, You shall present a contribution to the LORD.
- 20 *Ye shall offer up a cake of the first of your dough for an heave offering: as ye do the heave offering of the threshingfloor, so shall ye heave it.* Of the first of Your dough You shall present a loaf as a contribution; like a contribution from the threshing floor, so shall You present it.
- 21 *Of the first of your dough ye shall give unto the LORD an heave offering in your generations.* Some of the first of Your dough You shall give to the LORD as a contribution throughout Your generations.
- 22 *And if ye have erred, and not observed all these commandments, which the LORD hath spoken unto Moses,* But if You sin unintentionally, and do not observe all these commandments that the LORD has spoken to Moses—
- 23 *Even all that the LORD hath commanded you by the hand of Moses, from the day that the LORD commanded Moses, and henceforward among your generations;* all that the LORD has commanded You by Moses, from the day that the LORD gave commandment, and onward throughout Your generations—
- 24 *Then it shall be, if ought be committed by ignorance without the knowledge of the congregation, that all the congregation shall offer one young bullock for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour unto the LORD, with his meat offering, and his drink offering, according to the manner, and one kid of the goats for a sin offering.* then if it was done unintentionally without the knowledge of the congregation, all the congregation shall offer one bull from the herd for a burnt offering, a sweet savour unto the LORD, with its grain offering and its drink offering, according to the rule, and one male goat for a sin offering.

- 25 *And the priest shall make an atonement for all the congregation of the children of Israel, and it shall be forgiven them; for it is ignorance: and they shall bring their offering, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD, and their sin offering before the LORD, for their ignorance:* the priest shall make atonement for all the congregation of the people of Israel. They shall be forgiven, because it was a mistake. They have brought their offering, a offering made by fire to the LORD. Their sin offering before the LORD for their mistake.
- 26 *And it shall be forgiven all the congregation of the children of Israel, and the stranger that sojourneth among them; seeing all the people were in ignorance.* all the congregation of the people of Israel shall be forgiven, and the stranger who sojourns among them, because the whole population was involved in the mistake.
- 27 *And if any soul sin through ignorance, then he shall bring a she goat of the first year for a sin offering.* If one person sins unintentionally, He shall offer a female goat a year old for a sin offering.
- 28 *And the priest shall make an atonement for the soul that sinneth ignorantly, when he sinneth by ignorance before the LORD, to make an atonement for him; and it shall be forgiven him.* the priest shall make atonement before the LORD for the person who makes a mistake, when He sins unintentionally, to make atonement for Him. He shall be forgiven.
- 29 *Ye shall have one law for him that sinneth through ignorance, both for him that is born among the children of Israel, and for the stranger that sojourneth among them.* You shall have one law for Him who does anything unintentionally, for Him who is native among the people of Israel and for the stranger who sojourns among them.
- 30 *But the soul that doeth ought presumptuously, whether he be born in the land, or a stranger, the same reproacheth the LORD; and that soul shall be cut off from among his people.* But the person who does anything with a high hand, whether He is native or a stranger, reviles the LORD, and that person shall be cut off from among His people.

- 31 *Because he hath despised the word of the LORD, and hath broken his commandment, that soul shall utterly be cut off; his iniquity shall be upon him.* Because He has despised the word of the LORD and has broken His commandment, that person shall be utterly cut off; His iniquity shall be on Him.'
- 32 *And while the children of Israel were in the wilderness, they found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.* While the people of Israel were in the wilderness, they found a man gathering sticks on the Sabbath day.
- 33 *And they that found him gathering sticks brought him unto Moses and Aaron, and unto all the congregation.* those who found him gathering sticks brought him to Moses and Aaron and to all the congregation.
- 34 *And they put him in ward, because it was not declared what should be done to him.* They put him in custody, because it had not been made clear what should be done to him.
- 35 *And the LORD said unto Moses, The man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones without the camp.* the LORD said to Moses, 'The man shall be put to death; all the congregation shall stone him with stones outside the camp.'
- 36 *And all the congregation brought him without the camp, and stoned him with stones, and he died; as the LORD commanded Moses.* all the congregation brought Him outside the camp and stoned Him to death with stones, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 37 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 38 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and bid them that they make them fringes in the borders of their garments throughout their generations, and that they put upon the fringe of the borders a ribband of blue:* 'Speak to the people of Israel, and tell them to make tassels on the corners of their garments throughout their generations, and to put a cord of blue on the tassel of each corner.

39	<i>And it shall be unto you for a fringe, that ye may look upon it, and remember all the commandments of the LORD, and do them; and that ye seek not after your own heart and your own eyes, after which ye use to go a whoring:</i>	it shall be a tassel for You to look at and remember all the commandments of the LORD, to do them, not to follow after Your own heart and Your own eyes, which You are inclined to pursue after in unfaithfulness.
40	<i>That ye may remember, and do all my commandments, and be holy unto your God.</i>	So You shall remember and do all my commandments, and be holy to Your God.
41	<i>I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: I am the LORD your God.</i>	I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt to be Your God: I am the LORD Your God.'

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Lev 23:10
- v3 — Ex 29:18; Gen 8:21
- v4 — Ex 29:40; Lev 2:1; Lev 23:13; Lev 6:14
- v5 — Num 28:14; Num 28:7
- v15 — Num 15:29; Num 9:14; Ex 12:49
- v22 — Lev 4:2
- v30 — Heb 10:26; Ps 19:13; Deut 1:43; Deut 29:19-20; Heb 10:29
- v31 — 2 Sam 12:9; Prov 13:13; Ezek 18:20
- v35 — Acts 7:58; Ex 31:14-15
- v38 — Matt 23:5; Deut 22:12; Luke 8:44; Matt 9:20
- v39 — Ps 73:27; Ps 106:39; Prov 28:26; Ezek 6:9; Ex 13:9
- v40 — Rom 12:1; 1 Thess 4:7; Lev 11:44-45; 1 Pet 1:15-16; Col 1:2

Chapter 16

Korah, Dathan, and Abiram lead a rebellion of 250 leaders against the authority of Moses and Aaron. The LORD causes the earth to open and swallow Korah's company alive, and fire from the LORD consumes the 250 men offering incense. The next day the congregation grumbles again, and a plague kills 14,700 before Aaron makes atonement.

- 1 *Now Korah, the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, and Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, and On, the son of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took men:* Now Korah the son of Izhar, son of Kohath, son of Levi, and Dathan and Abiram the sons of Eliab, and On the son of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took men.
- 2 *And they rose up before Moses, with certain of the children of Israel, two hundred and fifty princes of the assembly, famous in the congregation, men of renown:* they rose up before Moses, with 250 chiefs of the congregation, chosen from the assembly, well-known men.
- 3 *And they gathered themselves together against Moses and against Aaron, and said unto them, Ye take too much upon you, seeing all the congregation are holy, every one of them, and the LORD is among them: wherefore then lift ye up yourselves above the congregation of the LORD?* They assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron and said to them, 'You have gone too far! For all in the congregation are holy, every one of them. The LORD is among them. Why then do You exalt yourselves above the assembly of the LORD?'
- 4 *And when Moses heard it, he fell upon his face:* When Moses heard it, he fell on his face,
- 5 *And he spake unto Korah and unto all his company, saying, Even to morrow the LORD will shew who are his, and who is holy; and will cause him to come near unto him: even him whom he hath chosen will he cause to come near unto him.* he said to Korah and all His company, 'In the morning the LORD will show who is His, and who is holy, and will bring Him near to Himself. The one whom He chooses He will bring near to Himself.
- 6 *This do; Take you censers, Korah, and all his company;* Do this: take censers, Korah and all His company;
- 7 *And put fire therein, and put incense in them before the LORD to morrow: and it shall be that the man whom the LORD doth choose, he shall be holy: ye take too much upon you, ye sons of Levi.* put fire in them and put incense before the LORD tomorrow, and the man whom the LORD chooses shall be the holy one. You have gone too far, sons of Levi!'

- 8 *And Moses said unto Korah, Hear, I pray you, ye sons of Levi:* Moses said to Korah, 'Hear now, you sons of Levi:
- 9 *Seemeth it but a small thing unto you, that the God of Israel hath separated you from the congregation of Israel, to bring you near to himself to do the service of the tabernacle of the LORD, and to stand before the congregation to minister unto them?* is it too small a thing for You that the God of Israel has separated You from the congregation of Israel, to bring You near to Himself, to do service in the tabernacle of the LORD and to stand before the congregation to minister to them,
- 10 *And he hath brought thee near to him, and all thy brethren the sons of Levi with thee: and seek ye the priesthood also?* that He has brought You near Him. All Your brothers the sons of Levi with You? And would You seek the priesthood also?
- 11 *For which cause both thou and all thy company are gathered together against the LORD: and what is Aaron, that ye murmur against him?* Therefore it is against the LORD that You and all Your company have gathered together. What is Aaron that you grumble against him?
- 12 *And Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab: which said, We will not come up:* Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiram the sons of Eliab. They said, 'We will not come up.
- 13 *Is it a small thing that thou hast brought us up out of a land that floweth with milk and honey, to kill us in the wilderness, except thou make thyself altogether a prince over us?* Is it a small thing that you have brought us up out of a land flowing with milk and honey, to kill us in the wilderness, that you must also make yourself a prince over us?
- 14 *Moreover thou hast not brought us into a land that floweth with milk and honey, or given us inheritance of fields and vineyards: wilt thou put out the eyes of these men? we will not come up.* Moreover, you have not brought us into a land flowing with milk and honey, nor given us an inheritance of fields and vineyards. Will you put out the eyes of these men? We will not come up.'

- 15 *And Moses was very wroth, and said unto the LORD, Respect not thou their offering: I have not taken one ass from them, neither have I hurt one of them.* Moses was very angry and said to the LORD, 'Do not respect their offering. I have not taken one donkey from them. I have not harmed one of them.'
- 16 *And Moses said unto Korah, Be thou and all thy company before the LORD, thou, and they, and Aaron, to morrow:* Moses said to Korah, 'Be present, you and all your company, before the LORD, You and they and Aaron, tomorrow.'
- 17 *And take every man his censer, and put incense in them, and bring ye before the LORD every man his censer, two hundred and fifty censers; thou also, and Aaron, each of you his censer.* let every one of you take his censer and put incense on it, and every one of you bring before the LORD His censer — 250 censers — you also and Aaron, each his censer.'
- 18 *And they took every man his censer, and put fire in them, and laid incense thereon, and stood in the door of the tabernacle of the congregation with Moses and Aaron.* So every man took his censer and put fire in it and laid incense on it and stood at the entrance of the tent of meeting with Moses and Aaron.
- 19 *And Korah gathered all the congregation against them unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto all the congregation.* Then Korah assembled all the congregation against them at the entrance of the tent of meeting. And the glory of the LORD appeared to all the congregation.
- 20 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying,
- 21 *Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment.* 'Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment.'

- 22 *And they fell upon their faces, and said, O God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, shall one man sin, and wilt thou be wroth with all the congregation?* they fell on their faces and said, 'O God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, shall one man sin, and will You be angry with all the congregation?'
- 23 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 24 *Speak unto the congregation, saying, Get you up from about the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram.* 'Tell the congregation to get away from the dwelling of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram.'
- 25 *And Moses rose up and went unto Dathan and Abiram; and the elders of Israel followed him.* Then Moses rose and went to Dathan and Abiram, and the elders of Israel followed him.
- 26 *And he spake unto the congregation, saying, Depart, I pray you, from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest ye be consumed in all their sins.* he spoke to the congregation, saying, 'Depart, please, from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest you be swept away in all their sins.'
- 27 *So they gat up from the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every side: and Dathan and Abiram came out, and stood in the door of their tents, and their wives, and their sons, and their little children.* So they moved away from the dwelling of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every side. And Dathan and Abiram came out and stood at the door of their tents, together with their wives, their sons. Their little children.
- 28 *And Moses said, Hereby ye shall know that the LORD hath sent me to do all these works; for I have not done them of mine own mind.* Moses said, 'By this you shall know that the LORD has sent me to do all these works, and that it has not been of my own accord.
- 29 *If these men die the common death of all men, or if they be visited after the visitation of all men; then the LORD hath not sent me.* If these men die as all men die, or if they are visited by the fate of all mankind, then the LORD has not sent me.

- 30 *But if the LORD make a new thing, and the earth open her mouth, and swallow them up, with all that appertain unto them, and they go down quick into the pit; then ye shall understand that these men have provoked the LORD.* But if the LORD does something unprecedented, and the ground opens its mouth and swallows them up with all that belongs to them. They go down alive into the pit, then You shall know that these men have despised the LORD.'
- 31 *And it came to pass, as he had made an end of speaking all these words, that the ground clave asunder that was under them:* as soon as He had finished speaking all these words, the ground under them split apart.
- 32 *And the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up, and their houses, and all the men that appertained unto Korah, and all their goods.* the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up, with their households and all the people who belonged to Korah and all their goods.
- 33 *They, and all that appertained to them, went down alive into the pit, and the earth closed upon them: and they perished from among the congregation.* So they and all that belonged to them went down alive into the pit, and the earth closed over them. They perished from the midst of the assembly.
- 34 *And all Israel that were round about them fled at the cry of them: for they said, Lest the earth swallow us up also.* all Israel who were around them fled at their cry, for they said, 'Lest the earth swallow us up too!'
- 35 *And there came out a fire from the LORD, and consumed the two hundred and fifty men that offered incense.* fire came out from the LORD and consumed the 250 men offering the incense.
- 36 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* Then the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 37 *Speak unto Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, that he take up the censers out of the burning, and scatter thou the fire yonder; for they are hallowed.* 'Tell Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest to take up the censers out of the blaze. Then scatter the fire far and wide, for they have become holy —

- 38 *The censers of these sinners against their own souls, let them be made broad plates for a covering of the altar: for they offered them before the LORD, therefore they are hallowed: and they shall be a sign unto the children of Israel.* the censers of these men who sinned at the cost of their lives. Let them be hammered into flat plates as a covering for the altar, for they offered them before the LORD. They have become holy. Thus they shall be a sign to the people of Israel.'
- 39 *And Eleazar the priest took the brasen censers, wherewith they that were burnt had offered; and they were made broad plates for a covering of the altar:* So Eleazar the priest took the bronze censers, which those who were burned had offered. They were hammered out as a covering for the altar,
- 40 *To be a memorial unto the children of Israel, that no stranger, which is not of the seed of Aaron, come near to offer incense before the LORD; that he be not as Korah, and as his company: as the LORD said to him by the hand of Moses.* to be a reminder to the people of Israel, so that no outsider, who is not of the descendants of Aaron, should draw near to offer incense before the LORD, lest He become like Korah and His company — as the LORD said to Him through Moses.
- 41 *But on the morrow all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron, saying, Ye have killed the people of the LORD.* But on the next day all the congregation of the people of Israel grumbled against Moses and against Aaron, saying, 'You have killed the people of the LORD.'
- 42 *And it came to pass, when the congregation was gathered against Moses and against Aaron, that they looked toward the tabernacle of the congregation: and, behold, the cloud covered it, and the glory of the LORD appeared.* when the congregation had assembled against Moses and against Aaron, they turned toward the tent of meeting. And the cloud covered it, and the glory of the LORD appeared.
- 43 *And Moses and Aaron came before the tabernacle of the congregation.* Moses and Aaron came to the front of the tent of meeting.
- 44 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

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| <p>45 <i>Get you up from among this congregation, that I may consume them as in a moment. And they fell upon their faces.</i></p> <p>46 <i>And Moses said unto Aaron, Take a censer, and put fire therein from off the altar, and put on incense, and go quickly unto the congregation, and make an atonement for them: for there is wrath gone out from the LORD; the plague is begun.</i></p> <p>47 <i>And Aaron took as Moses commanded, and ran into the midst of the congregation; and, behold, the plague was begun among the people: and he put on incense, and made an atonement for the people.</i></p> <p>48 <i>And he stood between the dead and the living; and the plague was stayed.</i></p> <p>49 <i>Now they that died in the plague were fourteen thousand and seven hundred, beside them that died about the matter of Korah.</i></p> <p>50 <i>And Aaron returned unto Moses unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and the plague was stayed.</i></p> | <p>'Get away from the midst of this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment.' And they fell on their faces.</p> <p>Moses said to Aaron, 'Take your censer, and put fire on it from off the altar and lay incense on it and carry it quickly to the congregation and make atonement for them, for wrath has gone out from the LORD; the plague has begun.'</p> <p>So Aaron took it as Moses said and ran into the midst of the assembly. And the plague had already begun among the people. And he put on the incense and made atonement for the people.</p> <p>He stood between the dead and the living, and the plague was stopped.</p> <p>Now those who died in the plague were 14,700, besides those who died in the affair of Korah.</p> <p>Aaron returned to Moses at the entrance of the tent of meeting, when the plague had been stopped.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jude 1:11; Deut 11:6; Ex 6:21
v3 — Ps 106:16
v4 — Num 14:5
v5 — Ps 65:4; Num 17:5; 2 Tim 2:19; Lev 10:3
v7 — Num 16:3
v9 — Deut 10:8; Isa 7:13
v22 — Num 27:16; Zech 12:1; Job 12:10; Eccl 12:7; Heb 12:9
v26 — Isa 52:11
v28 — Ex 3:12; John 6:38; Ezek 13:17; John 14:11; Jer 23:16
v32 — Num 26:11; Ps 106:17
v35 — Lev 10:2; Num 26:10; Ps 106:18
v46 — Num 8:19; Lev 10:6; 1 Chr 27:24

Chapter 17

The LORD commands that twelve staffs, one for each tribal leader, be placed in the tent of meeting to settle the dispute over the priesthood. Aaron's staff for the tribe of Levi sprouts, buds, blossoms, and produces ripe almonds overnight, confirming his chosen priesthood.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> | <p>The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Speak unto the children of Israel, and take of every one of them a rod according to the house of their fathers, of all their princes according to the house of their fathers twelve rods: write thou every man's name upon his rod.</i></p> | <p>'Speak to the people of Israel, and get from them a staff for each fathers' house, from all their chiefs according to their fathers' houses — twelve staffs. Write each man's name on his staff.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And thou shalt write Aaron's name upon the rod of Levi: for one rod shall be for the head of the house of their fathers.</i></p> | <p>write Aaron's name on the staff of Levi. For there shall be one staff for the head of each fathers' house.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And thou shalt lay them up in the tabernacle of the congregation before the testimony, where I will meet with you.</i></p> | <p>Then you shall deposit them in the tent of meeting before the testimony, where I meet with you.</p> |

- 5 *And it shall come to pass, that the man's rod, whom I shall choose, shall blossom: and I will make to cease from me the murmurings of the children of Israel, whereby they murmur against you.* the staff of the man whom I choose shall sprout. Thus I will make to cease from me the grumbings of the people of Israel, which they grumble against you.'
- 6 *And Moses spake unto the children of Israel, and every one of their princes gave him a rod apiece, for each prince one, according to their fathers' houses, even twelve rods: and the rod of Aaron was among their rods.* Moses spoke to the people of Israel. And all their chiefs gave him staffs, one for each chief, according to their fathers' houses — twelve staffs. And the staff of Aaron was among their staffs.
- 7 *And Moses laid up the rods before the LORD in the tabernacle of witness.* Moses deposited the staffs before the LORD in the tent of the testimony.
- 8 *And it came to pass, that on the morrow Moses went into the tabernacle of witness; and, behold, the rod of Aaron for the house of Levi was budded, and brought forth buds, and bloomed blossoms, and yielded almonds.* On the next day Moses went into the tent of the testimony, and the staff of Aaron for the house of Levi had sprouted and put forth buds and produced blossoms. It bore ripe almonds.
- 9 *And Moses brought out all the rods from before the LORD unto all the children of Israel: and they looked, and took every man his rod.* Then Moses brought out all the staffs from before the LORD to all the people of Israel. And they looked, and each man took his staff.
- 10 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Bring Aaron's rod again before the testimony, to be kept for a token against the rebels; and thou shalt quite take away their murmurings from me, that they die not.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Put back the staff of Aaron before the testimony, to be kept as a sign for the rebels, that you may make an end of their grumbings against me, lest they die.'
- 11 *And Moses did so: as the LORD commanded him, so did he.* Moses did so; as the LORD commanded Him, so He did.

- 12 *And the children of Israel spake unto Moses, saying, Behold, we die, we perish, we all perish.* the people of Israel said to Moses, 'We are perishing, we are all perishing.'
- 13 *Whosoever cometh any thing near unto the tabernacle of the LORD shall die: shall we be consumed with dying?* Everyone who comes near, who comes near to the tabernacle of the LORD, dies. Are we all to perish?'

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

v5 — Num 16:5

v8 — Ezek 17:24; John 15:1-6; Ps 132:17-18; Isa 4:2; Num 17:5

v10 — Heb 9:4; Eph 5:6

Chapter 18

The LORD tells Aaron that he and his sons shall bear the iniquity of the sanctuary and the priesthood. The Levites are given to serve Aaron, and the priests receive the firstfruits, firstborn offerings, and portions of the sacrifices; the Levites receive all the tithes in Israel as their inheritance, and they in turn tithe to the priests.

- 1 *And the LORD said unto Aaron, Thou and thy sons and thy father's house with thee shall bear the iniquity of the sanctuary: and thou and thy sons with thee shall bear the iniquity of your priesthood.* The LORD said to Aaron, 'You and your sons and your father's house with you shall bear iniquity of the sanctuary, and you and your sons with you shall bear iniquity of your priesthood.'

- 2 *And thy brethren also of the tribe of Levi, the tribe of thy father, bring thou with thee, that they may be joined unto thee, and minister unto thee: but thou and thy sons with thee shall minister before the tabernacle of witness.* bring Your brothers also, the tribe of Levi, the tribe of Your father, that they may join You and minister to You while You and Your sons with You are before the tent of the testimony.
- 3 *And they shall keep thy charge, and the charge of all the tabernacle: only they shall not come nigh the vessels of the sanctuary and the altar, that neither they, nor ye also, die.* They shall keep guard over You and over the whole tent. But They shall not come near to the vessels of the sanctuary or to the altar lest they, and You, die.
- 4 *And they shall be joined unto thee, and keep the charge of the tabernacle of the congregation, for all the service of the tabernacle: and a stranger shall not come nigh unto you.* They shall join You and keep guard over the tent of meeting for all the service of the tent, and no outsider shall come near You.
- 5 *And ye shall keep the charge of the sanctuary, and the charge of the altar: that there be no wrath any more upon the children of Israel.* you shall keep guard over the sanctuary and over the altar, that there may never again be wrath on the people of Israel.
- 6 *And I, behold, I have taken your brethren the Levites from among the children of Israel: to you they are given as a gift for the LORD, to do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation.* I have taken Your brothers the Levites from among the people of Israel. They are a gift to you, given to the LORD, to do the service of the tent of meeting.
- 7 *Therefore thou and thy sons with thee shall keep your priest's office for every thing of the altar, and within the veil; and ye shall serve: I have given your priest's office unto you as a service of gift: and the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.* you and Your sons with You shall guard Your priesthood for all that concerns the altar and that is within the veil. You shall serve. I give Your priesthood as a gift, and any outsider who comes near shall be put to death.'

- 8 *And the LORD spake unto Aaron, Behold, I also have given thee the charge of mine heave offerings of all the hallowed things of the children of Israel; unto thee have I given them by reason of the anointing, and to thy sons, by an ordinance for ever.* Then the LORD spoke to Aaron, ' I have given you charge of the contributions made to me, all the consecrated things of the people of Israel. I have given them to you as a portion and to your sons as a perpetual due.
- 9 *This shall be thine of the most holy things, reserved from the fire: every oblation of theirs, every meat offering of theirs, and every sin offering of theirs, and every trespass offering of theirs, which they shall render unto me, shall be most holy for thee and for thy sons.* This shall be Yours of the most holy things, reserved from the fire: every offering of theirs, every grain offering of theirs, every sin offering of theirs, and every guilt offering of theirs, which they render to me, shall be most holy for You and for Your sons.
- 10 *In the most holy place shalt thou eat it; every male shall eat it: it shall be holy unto thee.* In a most holy place You shall eat it. Every male may eat it; it is holy to You.
- 11 *And this is thine; the heave offering of their gift, with all the wave offerings of the children of Israel: I have given them unto thee, and to thy sons and to thy daughters with thee, by a statute for ever: every one that is clean in thy house shall eat of it.* This also is Yours: the contribution of their gift, all the wave offerings of the people of Israel. I have given them to you, and to Your sons and daughters with You, as a perpetual due. Everyone who is clean in Your house may eat it.
- 12 *All the best of the oil, and all the best of the wine, and of the wheat, the firstfruits of them which they shall offer unto the LORD, them have I given thee.* All the best of the oil and all the best of the wine and of the grain, the firstfruits of what they give to the LORD, I give to You.
- 13 *And whatsoever is first ripe in the land, which they shall bring unto the LORD, shall be thine; every one that is clean in thine house shall eat of it.* The first ripe fruits of all that is in their land, which they bring to the LORD, shall be Yours. Everyone who is clean in Your house may eat it.

- 14 *Every thing devoted in Israel shall be thine.* Every devoted thing in Israel shall be Yours.
- 15 *Every thing that openeth the matrix in all flesh, which they bring unto the LORD, whether it be of men or beasts, shall be thine: nevertheless the firstborn of man shalt thou surely redeem, and the firstling of unclean beasts shalt thou redeem.* Everything that opens the womb of all flesh, which they offer to the LORD, whether human or animal, shall be Yours. Nevertheless, the firstborn of man You shall redeem, and the firstborn of unclean animals You shall redeem.
- 16 *And those that are to be redeemed from a month old shalt thou redeem, according to thine estimation, for the money of five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary, which is twenty gerahs.* their redemption price, at a month old You shall redeem them, shall be five shekels in silver, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, which is twenty gerahs.
- 17 *But the firstling of a cow, or the firstling of a sheep, or the firstling of a goat, thou shalt not redeem; they are holy: thou shalt sprinkle their blood upon the altar, and shalt burn their fat for an offering made by fire, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.* But the firstborn of a cow, or the firstborn of a sheep, or the firstborn of a goat, You shall not redeem; they are holy. You shall sprinkle their blood on the altar and shall burn their fat as a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 18 *And the flesh of them shall be thine, as the wave breast and as the right shoulder are thine.* But their flesh shall be Yours, as the breast that is waved and as the right thigh are Yours.
- 19 *All the heave offerings of the holy things, which the children of Israel offer unto the LORD, have I given thee, and thy sons and thy daughters with thee, by a statute for ever: it is a covenant of salt for ever before the LORD unto thee and to thy seed with thee.* All the contributions of the holy things that the people of Israel present to the LORD I give to You and to Your sons and daughters with You, as a perpetual due. It is a covenant of salt forever before the LORD for You and for Your seed with You.'

- 20 *And the LORD spake unto Aaron, Thou shalt have no inheritance in their land, neither shalt thou have any part among them: I am thy part and thine inheritance among the children of Israel.* the LORD said to Aaron, 'You shall have no inheritance in their land, neither shall you have any portion among them. I am your portion and your inheritance among the people of Israel.
- 21 *And, behold, I have given the children of Levi all the tenth in Israel for an inheritance, for their service which they serve, even the service of the tabernacle of the congregation.* To the Levites I have given every tithe in Israel for an inheritance, in return for their service that they do, their service in the tent of meeting.
- 22 *Neither must the children of Israel henceforth come nigh the tabernacle of the congregation, lest they bear sin, and die.* from now on the people of Israel shall not come near the tent of meeting, lest they bear sin and die.
- 23 *But the Levites shall do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation, and they shall bear their iniquity: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations, that among the children of Israel they have no inheritance.* But the Levites shall do the service of the tent of meeting. They shall bear their iniquity. It shall be a perpetual statute throughout Your generations, and among the people of Israel they shall have no inheritance.
- 24 *But the tithes of the children of Israel, which they offer as an heave offering unto the LORD, I have given to the Levites to inherit: therefore I have said unto them, Among the children of Israel they shall have no inheritance.* For the tithe of the people of Israel, which they present as a contribution to the LORD, I have given to the Levites for an inheritance. Therefore I have said of them that they shall have no inheritance among the people of Israel.'
- 25 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,

- 26 *Thus speak unto the Levites, and say unto them, When ye take of the children of Israel the tithes which I have given you from them for your inheritance, then ye shall offer up an heave offering of it for the LORD, even a tenth part of the tithe.* 'Speak to the Levites and say to them, when You take from the people of Israel the tithe that I have given you from them for Your inheritance, then You shall present a contribution from it to the LORD, a tithe of the tithe.
- 27 *And this your heave offering shall be reckoned unto you, as though it were the corn of the threshingfloor, and as the fulness of the winepress.* your contribution shall be counted to You as though it were the grain of the threshing floor and as the fullness of the winepress.
- 28 *Thus ye also shall offer an heave offering unto the LORD of all your tithes, which ye receive of the children of Israel; and ye shall give thereof the LORD's heave offering to Aaron the priest.* So You shall also present a contribution to the LORD from all Your tithes, which You receive from the people of Israel. And from it you shall give the LORD's contribution to Aaron the priest.
- 29 *Out of all your gifts ye shall offer every heave offering of the LORD, of all the best thereof, even the hallowed part thereof out of it.* Out of all the gifts to You, You shall present every contribution due to the LORD; from each its best part is to be dedicated.'
- 30 *Therefore thou shalt say unto them, When ye have heaved the best thereof from it, then it shall be counted unto the Levites as the increase of the threshingfloor, and as the increase of the winepress.* So You shall say to them, 'When You have offered from it the best of it, then the rest shall be counted to the Levites as produce of the threshing floor, and as produce of the winepress.
- 31 *And ye shall eat it in every place, ye and your households: for it is your reward for your service in the tabernacle of the congregation.* you may eat it in any place, You and Your households, for it is Your reward in return for Your service in the tent of meeting.

- 32

And ye shall bear no sin by reason of it, when ye have heaved from it the best of it: neither shall ye pollute the holy things of the children of Israel, lest ye die.
- you shall bear no sin by reason of it, when You have contributed the best of it. But You shall not profane the holy things of the people of Israel, lest you die.'

Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 28:38
- v3 — Num 4:15
- v5 — Ex 27:21
- v6 — Num 3:9
- v7 — John 3:27; Num 3:10; Rom 15:15-16
- v9 — Lev 7:7; Lev 14:13
- v13 — Ex 22:29
- v14 — Lev 27:28
- v19 — 2 Chr 13:5
- v20 — Ezek 44:28; Deut 10:9; Josh 13:33; Deut 18:1-2; Lam 3:24
- v22 — Lev 22:9
- v26 — Neh 10:38

Chapter 19

The LORD gives the law of the red heifer: a perfect, unblemished red cow is slaughtered and burned outside the camp, and its ashes are mixed with water to create the water of purification. Anyone who touches a dead body is unclean seven days and must be sprinkled with this water on the third and seventh day.

- 1

And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
- The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying,
- 2

This is the ordinance of the law which the LORD hath commanded, saying, Speak unto the children of Israel, that they bring thee a red heifer without spot, wherein is no blemish, and upon which never came yoke:
- 'This is the statute of the law that the LORD has commanded: Tell the people of Israel to bring you a red heifer without defect, in which there is no blemish, and on which a yoke has never come.

- 3 *And ye shall give her unto Eleazar the priest, that he may bring her forth without the camp, and one shall slay her before his face:* you shall give it to Eleazar the priest. It shall be taken outside the camp and slaughtered before him.
- 4 *And Eleazar the priest shall take of her blood with his finger, and sprinkle of her blood directly before the tabernacle of the congregation seven times:* Eleazar the priest shall take some of its blood with his finger and sprinkle some of its blood toward the front of the tent of meeting seven times.
- 5 *And one shall burn the heifer in his sight; her skin, and her flesh, and her blood, with her dung, shall he burn:* the heifer shall be burned in his sight. Its skin, its flesh, and its blood, with its dung, shall be burned.
- 6 *And the priest shall take cedar wood, and hyssop, and scarlet, and cast it into the midst of the burning of the heifer.* the priest shall take cedarwood and hyssop and scarlet yarn, and throw them into the midst of the burning of the heifer.
- 7 *Then the priest shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp, and the priest shall be unclean until the even.* Then the priest shall wash his clothes and bathe his body in water, and afterward he may come into the camp. But the priest shall be unclean until evening.
- 8 *And he that burneth her shall wash his clothes in water, and bathe his flesh in water, and shall be unclean until the even.* The one who burns the heifer shall wash his clothes in water and bathe his body in water and shall be unclean until evening.
- 9 *And a man that is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer, and lay them up without the camp in a clean place, and it shall be kept for the congregation of the children of Israel for a water of separation: it is a purification for sin.* a man who is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer and deposit them outside the camp in a clean place. And they shall be kept for the water for impurity for the congregation of the people of Israel; it is a purification offering.

- 10 *And he that gathereth the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: and it shall be unto the children of Israel, and unto the stranger that sojourneth among them, for a statute for ever.* the one who gathers the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes and be unclean until evening. And this shall be a perpetual statute for the people of Israel, and for the stranger who sojourns among them.
- 11 *He that toucheth the dead body of any man shall be unclean seven days.* Whoever touches the dead body of any person shall be unclean seven days.
- 12 *He shall purify himself with it on the third day, and on the seventh day he shall be clean: but if he purify not himself the third day, then the seventh day he shall not be clean.* He shall cleanse himself with the water on the third day and on the seventh day, and so be clean. But if he does not cleanse himself on the third day and on the seventh day, he will not become clean.
- 13 *Whosoever toucheth the dead body of any man that is dead, and purifieth not himself, defileth the tabernacle of the LORD; and that soul shall be cut off from Israel: because the water of separation was not sprinkled upon him, he shall be unclean; his uncleanness is yet upon him.* Whoever touches a dead person, the body of any human being who has died, and does not cleanse Himself, defiles the tabernacle of the LORD, and that person shall be cut off from Israel. Because the water for impurity was not thrown on Him, He shall be unclean. His uncleanness is still on Him.
- 14 *This is the law, when a man dieth in a tent: all that come into the tent, and all that is in the tent, shall be unclean seven days.* This is the law when someone dies in a tent: everyone who comes into the tent and everyone who is in the tent shall be unclean seven days.
- 15 *And every open vessel, which hath no covering bound upon it, is unclean.* every open vessel that has no cover fastened on it is unclean.
- 16 *And whosoever toucheth one that is slain with a sword in the open fields, or a dead body, or a bone of a man, or a grave, shall be unclean seven days.* Whoever in the open field touches someone who was killed with a sword or who died naturally, or touches a human bone or a grave, shall be unclean seven days.

- 17 *And for an unclean person they shall take of the ashes of the burnt heifer of purification for sin, and running water shall be put thereto in a vessel:* For the unclean they shall take some ashes of the burnt purification offering, and fresh water shall be added to them in a vessel.
- 18 *And a clean person shall take hyssop, and dip it in the water, and sprinkle it upon the tent, and upon all the vessels, and upon the persons that were there, and upon him that touched a bone, or one slain, or one dead, or a grave:* Then a clean person shall take hyssop and dip it in the water and sprinkle it on the tent and on all the furnishings and on the persons who were there and on whoever touched the bone, or the slain or the dead or the grave.
- 19 *And the clean person shall sprinkle upon the unclean on the third day, and on the seventh day: and on the seventh day he shall purify himself, and wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and shall be clean at even.* the clean person shall sprinkle it on the unclean on the third day and on the seventh day. Thus on the seventh day He shall cleanse Him. He shall wash His clothes and bathe Himself in water, and at evening He shall be clean.
- 20 *But the man that shall be unclean, and shall not purify himself, that soul shall be cut off from among the congregation, because he hath defiled the sanctuary of the LORD: the water of separation hath not been sprinkled upon him; he is unclean.* But the man who is unclean and does not cleanse himself, that person shall be cut off from the midst of the assembly, since He has defiled the sanctuary of the LORD. Because the water for impurity has not been thrown on Him, He is unclean.
- 21 *And it shall be a perpetual statute unto them, that he that sprinkleth the water of separation shall wash his clothes; and he that toucheth the water of separation shall be unclean until even.* it shall be a perpetual statute for them. The one who sprinkles the water for impurity shall wash His clothes, and the one who touches the water for impurity shall be unclean until evening.
- 22 *And whatsoever the unclean person toucheth shall be unclean; and the soul that toucheth it shall be unclean until even.* whatever the unclean person touches shall be unclean, and anyone who touches it shall be unclean until evening.'

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Lev 22:20-25; Deut 21:3; 1 Pet 1:19; 1 Sam 6:7; Phil 2:6-8
- v3 — Lev 4:12
- v4 — Lev 4:17
- v5 — Ex 29:14
- v6 — Lev 14:4
- v11 — Num 5:2; Num 31:19; Lev 21:1
- v12 — Num 31:19
- v13 — Lev 15:31
- v18 — Ezek 36:25-27; Heb 9:14
- v19 — 1 John 1:7; Heb 10:22; Ezek 36:25; Eph 5:25-27
- v21 — Heb 9:13-14; Heb 10:4

Chapter 20

The congregation arrives at Kadesh, where Miriam dies. The people quarrel over the lack of water, and the LORD tells Moses to speak to the rock; instead Moses strikes it twice and is forbidden from entering the Promised Land. Edom refuses Israel passage, and Aaron dies on Mount Hor, where Eleazar succeeds him as priest.

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| 1 | <i>Then came the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, into the desert of Zin in the first month: and the people abode in Kadesh; and Miriam died there, and was buried there.</i> | Then the whole congregation of the people of Israel came into the wilderness of Zin in the first month, and the people stayed in Kadesh. And Miriam died there and was buried there. |
| 2 | <i>And there was no water for the congregation: and they gathered themselves together against Moses and against Aaron.</i> | Now there was no water for the congregation. And they assembled themselves against Moses and against Aaron. |

- 3 *And the people chode with Moses, and spake, saying, Would God that we had died when our brethren died before the LORD!* the people quarreled with Moses and said, 'If only we had perished when our brothers perished before the LORD!
- 4 *And why have ye brought up the congregation of the LORD into this wilderness, that we and our cattle should die there?* Why have You brought the assembly of the LORD into this wilderness, that we should die here, both we and our livestock?
- 5 *And wherefore have ye made us to come up out of Egypt, to bring us in unto this evil place? it is no place of seed, or of figs, or of vines, or of pomegranates; neither is there any water to drink.* why have You made us come up out of Egypt to bring us to this evil place? It is no place for grain or figs or vines or pomegranates, and there is no water to drink.'
- 6 *And Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and they fell upon their faces: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto them.* Then Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the entrance of the tent of meeting and fell on their faces. And the glory of the LORD appeared to them.
- 7 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 8 *Take the rod, and gather thou the assembly together, thou, and Aaron thy brother, and speak ye unto the rock before their eyes; and it shall give forth his water, and thou shalt bring forth to them water out of the rock: so thou shalt give the congregation and their beasts drink.* 'Take the staff, and assemble the congregation, you and Aaron your brother, and tell the rock before their eyes to yield its water. So you shall bring water out of the rock for them and give drink to the congregation and their livestock.'
- 9 *And Moses took the rod from before the LORD, as he commanded him.* Moses took the staff from before the LORD, as He commanded Him.

- 10 *And Moses and Aaron gathered the congregation together before the rock, and he said unto them, Hear now, ye rebels; must we fetch you water out of this rock?* Then Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock. He said to them, 'Hear now, you rebels: shall we bring water for you out of this rock?'
- 11 *And Moses lifted up his hand, and with his rod he smote the rock twice: and the water came out abundantly, and the congregation drank, and their beasts also.* Moses lifted up his hand and struck the rock with his staff twice, and water came out abundantly, and the congregation drank. and their livestock also.
- 12 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron, Because ye believed me not, to sanctify me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore ye shall not bring this congregation into the land which I have given them.* the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, 'Because you did not believe in me, to uphold me as holy in the eyes of the people of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land that I have given them.'
- 13 *This is the water of Meribah; because the children of Israel strove with the LORD, and he was sanctified in them.* These are the waters of Meribah, where the people of Israel quarreled with the LORD, and through them He showed Himself holy.
- 14 *And Moses sent messengers from Kadesh unto the king of Edom, Thus saith thy brother Israel, Thou knowest all the travel that hath befallen us:* Moses sent messengers from Kadesh to the king of Edom: 'Thus says your brother Israel: You know all the hardship that has come upon us—
- 15 *How our fathers went down into Egypt, and we have dwelt in Egypt a long time; and the Egyptians vexed us, and our fathers:* how our fathers went down to Egypt. We lived in Egypt a long time, and the Egyptians dealt harshly with us and our fathers.
- 16 *And when we cried unto the LORD, he heard our voice, and sent an angel, and hath brought us forth out of Egypt: and, behold, we are in Kadesh, a city in the uttermost of thy border:* when we cried to the LORD, He heard our voice and sent an angel and brought us out of Egypt. And now we are in Kadesh, a city on the edge of Your territory.

- 17 *Let us pass, I pray thee, through thy country: we will not pass through the fields, or through the vineyards, neither will we drink of the water of the wells: we will go by the king's high way, we will not turn to the right hand nor to the left, until we have passed thy borders.* Please let us pass through your land. We will not pass through field or vineyard, or drink water from a well. We will go along the King's Highway. We will not turn aside to the right hand or to the left until we have passed through your territory.'
- 18 *And Edom said unto him, Thou shalt not pass by me, lest I come out against thee with the sword.* But Edom said to him, 'You shall not pass through, lest I come out with the sword against you.'
- 19 *And the children of Israel said unto him, We will go by the high way: and if I and my cattle drink of thy water, then I will pay for it: I will only, without doing any thing else, go through on my feet.* the people of Israel said to him, 'We will go up by the highway, and if we drink of your water, we and our livestock, then we will pay for it. Let us only pass through on foot — nothing more.'
- 20 *And he said, Thou shalt not go through. And Edom came out against him with much people, and with a strong hand.* But he said, 'You shall not pass through.' And Edom came out against them with a large army and with a strong force.
- 21 *Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his border: wherefore Israel turned away from him.* Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his territory, so Israel turned away from him.
- 22 *And the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, journeyed from Kadesh, and came unto mount Hor.* they journeyed from Kadesh, and the people of Israel, the whole congregation, came to Mount Hor.
- 23 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron in mount Hor, by the coast of the land of Edom, saying,* the LORD said to Moses and Aaron at Mount Hor, on the border of the land of Edom,

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| <p>24 <i>Aaron shall be gathered unto his people: for he shall not enter into the land which I have given unto the children of Israel, because ye rebelled against my word at the water of Meribah.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Take Aaron and Eleazar his son, and bring them up unto mount Hor:</i></p> <p>26 <i>And strip Aaron of his garments, and put them upon Eleazar his son: and Aaron shall be gathered unto his people, and shall die there.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And Moses did as the LORD commanded: and they went up into mount Hor in the sight of all the congregation.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And Moses stripped Aaron of his garments, and put them upon Eleazar his son; and Aaron died there in the top of the mount: and Moses and Eleazar came down from the mount.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And when all the congregation saw that Aaron was dead, they mourned for Aaron thirty days, even all the house of Israel.</i></p> | <p>'Let Aaron be gathered to his people, for he shall not enter the land that I have given to the people of Israel, because you rebelled against my command at the waters of Meribah.</p> <p>Take Aaron and Eleazar his son and bring them up to Mount Hor.</p> <p>strip Aaron of his garments and put them on Eleazar his son. And Aaron shall be gathered to his people and shall die there.'</p> <p>Moses did as the LORD commanded. They went up Mount Hor in the sight of all the congregation.</p> <p>Moses stripped Aaron of his garments and put them on Eleazar his son. And Aaron died there on the top of the mountain. Then Moses and Eleazar came down from the mountain.</p> <p>when all the congregation saw that Aaron had died, all the house of Israel wept for Aaron thirty days.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 13:21
- v2 — Num 16:19
- v3 — Ex 17:2
- v6 — Num 14:5
- v8 — Ex 4:17

v11 — 1 Cor 10:4; Ex 17:6; Num 20:8; Deut 8:15

v12 — Deut 1:37; Num 27:14; Ezek 36:23; Num 20:24; Deut 3:23-27

v13 — Ex 17:7; Ps 95:8

v16 — Ex 14:19

v19 — Deut 2:28; Deut 2:6

v20 — Judg 11:17; Amos 1:11

v24 — Gen 25:8; Deut 32:50

Chapter 21

Israel defeats the Canaanite king of Arad, then grows impatient and speaks against God and Moses. The LORD sends fiery serpents that kill many; when the people repent, Moses makes a bronze serpent on a pole and all who look at it live. Israel then defeats Sihon king of the Amorites and Og king of Bashan.

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| 1 <i>And when king Arad the Canaanite, which dwelt in the south, heard tell that Israel came by the way of the spies; then he fought against Israel, and took some of them prisoners.</i> | When the Canaanite, the king of Arad, who lived in the south, heard that Israel was coming by the way of the spies, he fought against Israel and took some of them captive. |
| 2 <i>And Israel vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou wilt indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities.</i> | Israel vowed a vow to the LORD and said, 'If You will indeed give this people into my hand, then I will devote their cities to destruction.' |
| 3 <i>And the LORD hearkened to the voice of Israel, and delivered up the Canaanites; and they utterly destroyed them and their cities: and he called the name of the place Hormah.</i> | the LORD heeded the voice of Israel and gave over the Canaanites. They devoted them and their cities to destruction. So the name of the place was called Hormah. |
| 4 <i>And they journeyed from mount Hor by the way of the Red sea, to compass the land of Edom: and the soul of the people was much discouraged because of the way.</i> | From Mount Hor they set out by the way to the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom. And the people became impatient on the way. |

- 5 *And the people spake against God, and against Moses, Wherefore have ye brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? for there is no bread, neither is there any water; and our soul loatheth this light bread.* the people spoke against God and against Moses, 'Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? For there is no food and no water. We detest this worthless food.'
- 6 *And the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died.* Then the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people. They bit the people, so that many people of Israel died.
- 7 *Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.* the people came to Moses and said, 'We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD and against You. Pray to the LORD, that He take away the serpents from us.' So Moses prayed for the people.
- 8 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Make thee a fiery serpent, and set it upon a pole: and it shall come to pass, that every one that is bitten, when he looketh upon it, shall live.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Make a fiery serpent and set it on a pole, and everyone who is bitten, when he sees it, shall live.'
- 9 *And Moses made a serpent of brass, and put it upon a pole, and it came to pass, that if a serpent had bitten any man, when he beheld the serpent of brass, he lived.* So Moses made a bronze serpent and set it on a pole. And if a serpent bit anyone, he would look at the bronze serpent and live.
- 10 *And the children of Israel set forward, and pitched in Oboth.* the people of Israel set out and camped in Oboth.
- 11 *And they journeyed from Oboth, and pitched at Ijeabarim, in the wilderness which is before Moab, toward the sunrising.* they set out from Oboth and camped at Iye-abarim, in the wilderness that is opposite Moab, toward the sunrise.
- 12 *From thence they removed, and pitched in the valley of Zared.* From there they set out and camped in the Valley of Zered.

- 13 *From thence they removed, and pitched on the other side of Arnon, which is in the wilderness that cometh out of the coasts of the Amorites: for Arnon is the border of Moab, between Moab and the Amorites.* From there they set out and camped on the other side of the Arnon, which is in the wilderness that extends from the border of the Amorites, for the Arnon is the border of Moab, between Moab and the Amorites.
- 14 *Wherefore it is said in the book of the wars of the LORD, What he did in the Red sea, and in the brooks of Arnon,* Therefore it is said in the Book of the Wars of the LORD, 'What He did in the Red sea, and in the brooks of Arnon,
- 15 *And at the stream of the brooks that goeth down to the dwelling of Ar, and lieth upon the border of Moab.* the slope of the valleys that extends to the dwelling of Ar, and leans to the border of Moab.'
- 16 *And from thence they went to Beer: that is the well whereof the LORD spake unto Moses, Gather the people together, and I will give them water.* from there they continued to Beer; that is the well of which the LORD said to Moses, 'Gather the people together, so that I may give them water.'
- 17 *Then Israel sang this song, Spring up, O well; sing ye unto it:* Then Israel sang this song: 'Spring up, O well! — sing to it! —
- 18 *The princes digged the well, the nobles of the people digged it, by the direction of the lawgiver, with their staves. And from the wilderness they went to Mattanah:* the well that the princes dug, that the nobles of the people excavated, with the scepter and with their staffs.' And from the wilderness they went on to Mattanah,
- 19 *And from Mattanah to Nahaliel: and from Nahaliel to Bamoth:* from Mattanah to Nahaliel, and from Nahaliel to Bamoth,
- 20 *And from Bamoth in the valley, that is in the country of Moab, to the top of Pisgah, which looketh toward Jeshimon.* from Bamoth to the valley lying in the region of Moab by the top of Pisgah that looks down on the desert.
- 21 *And Israel sent messengers unto Sihon king of the Amorites, saying,* Then Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, saying,

- 22 *Let me pass through thy land: we will not turn into the fields, or into the vineyards; we will not drink of the waters of the well: but we will go along by the king's high way, until we be past thy borders.* 'Let me pass through your land. We will not turn aside into field or vineyard. We will not drink the water of a well. We will go by the King's Highway until we have passed through your territory.'
- 23 *And Sihon would not suffer Israel to pass through his border: but Sihon gathered all his people together, and went out against Israel into the wilderness: and he came to Jahaz, and fought against Israel.* But Sihon would not allow Israel to pass through his territory. He gathered all his people together and went out against Israel to the wilderness and came to Jahaz and fought against Israel.
- 24 *And Israel smote him with the edge of the sword, and possessed his land from Arnon unto Jabbok, even unto the children of Ammon: for the border of the children of Ammon was strong.* Israel defeated him with the sword and took possession of his land from the Arnon to the Jabbok, as far as to the Ammonites, for the border of the Ammonites was strong.
- 25 *And Israel took all these cities: and Israel dwelt in all the cities of the Amorites, in Heshbon, and in all the villages thereof.* Israel took all these cities. Israel settled in all the cities of the Amorites, in Heshbon, and in all its villages.
- 26 *For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab, and taken all his land out of his hand, even unto Arnon.* For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab and taken all his land out of his hand, as far as the Arnon.
- 27 *Wherefore they that speak in proverbs say, Come into Heshbon, let the city of Sihon be built and prepared:* Therefore the ballad singers say, 'Come to Heshbon, let it be built; let the city of Sihon be established.
- 28 *For there is a fire gone out of Heshbon, a flame from the city of Sihon: it hath consumed Ar of Moab, and the lords of the high places of Arnon.* For fire came out from Heshbon, flame from the city of Sihon. It devoured Ar of Moab, and swallowed the heights of the Arnon.

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| <p>29 <i>Woe to thee, Moab! thou art undone, O people of Chemosh: he hath given his sons that escaped, and his daughters, into captivity unto Sihon king of the Amorites.</i></p> <p>30 <i>We have shot at them; Heshbon is perished even unto Dibon, and we have laid them waste even unto Nophah, which reacheth unto Medeba.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Thus Israel dwelt in the land of the Amorites.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And Moses sent to spy out Jaazer, and they took the villages thereof, and drove out the Amorites that were there.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And they turned and went up by the way of Bashan: and Og the king of Bashan went out against them, he, and all his people, to the battle at Edrei.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Fear him not: for I have delivered him into thy hand, and all his people, and his land; and thou shalt do to him as thou didst unto Sihon king of the Amorites, which dwelt at Heshbon.</i></p> <p>35 <i>So they smote him, and his sons, and all his people, until there was none left him alive: and they possessed his land.</i></p> | <p>Woe to you, O Moab! You are undone, O people of Chemosh! He has made his sons fugitives. His daughters captives, to an Amorite king, Sihon.</p> <p>So we overthrew them; Heshbon, as far as Dibon, perished. And we laid waste as far as Nophah; fire spread as far as Medeba.'</p> <p>So Israel lived in the land of the Amorites.</p> <p>Moses sent to spy out Jazer. They captured its villages and dispossessed the Amorites who were there.</p> <p>Then they turned and went up by the way to Bashan. And Og the king of Bashan came out against them, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei.</p> <p>But the LORD said to Moses, 'Do not fear him, for I have given him into your hand. All his people. His land. And you shall do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon.'</p> <p>So they defeated Him and His sons and all His people, until He had no survivor left. And they possessed His land.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Bashan (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Judg 1:16; Num 33:40

v2 — Gen 28:20; Judg 11:30

v4 — Ex 6:9; Judg 11:18; Num 32:7

v6 — 1 Cor 10:9; Jer 8:17; Deut 8:15; Amos 9:3-4

v7 — Acts 8:24; Num 11:2; Ps 78:34; Ex 8:8

v8 — John 3:14; Ps 106:43-45

v9 — John 3:14-15; John 6:40; Heb 12:2; 2 Kgs 18:4; John 12:32

v13 — Judg 11:18; Num 22:36

v15 — Deut 2:9; Num 21:28; Deut 2:18

v16 — Num 20:8; Isa 41:17-18; Isa 12:3

v29 — Judg 11:24; Jer 48:46; 2 Kgs 23:13

v30 — Jer 48:18; Isa 15:2

Chapter 22

Balak king of Moab, terrified of Israel, sends messengers to hire the prophet Balaam to curse them. God forbids Balaam to go, then permits him to go with the condition that he speak only God's words; on the way, the LORD's angel blocks the road and Balaam's donkey speaks to him.

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| 1 | <i>And the children of Israel set forward, and pitched in the plains of Moab on this side Jordan by Jericho.</i> | Then the people of Israel set out and camped in the plains of Moab beyond the Jordan at Jericho. |
| 2 | <i>And Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites.</i> | Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites. |
| 3 | <i>And Moab was sore afraid of the people, because they were many: and Moab was distressed because of the children of Israel.</i> | Moab was in great dread of the people, because they were many. Moab was overcome with fear of the people of Israel. |

- 4 *And Moab said unto the elders of Midian, Now shall this company lick up all that are round about us, as the ox licketh up the grass of the field. And Balak the son of Zippor was king of the Moabites at that time.* Moab said to the elders of Midian, 'This horde will now lick up all that is around us, as the ox licks up the grass of the field.' So Balak the son of Zippor, who was king of Moab at that time,
- 5 *He sent messengers therefore unto Balaam the son of Beor to Pethor, which is by the river of the land of the children of his people, to call him, saying, Behold, there is a people come out from Egypt: behold, they cover the face of the earth, and they abide over against me:* sent messengers to Balaam the son of Beor at Pethor, which is near the River in the land of the children of His people, to call Him, saying, 'There is a people who have come out of Egypt. They cover the face of the earth. They are dwelling opposite me.
- 6 *Come now therefore, I pray thee, curse me this people; for they are too mighty for me: peradventure I shall prevail, that we may smite them, and that I may drive them out of the land: for I wot that he whom thou blessest is blessed, and he whom thou cursest is cursed.* Come now, curse this people for me, since they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I shall be able to defeat them and drive them from the land, for I know that He whom You bless is blessed. He whom You curse is cursed.'
- 7 *And the elders of Moab and the elders of Midian departed with the rewards of divination in their hand; and they came unto Balaam, and spake unto him the words of Balak.* So the elders of Moab and the elders of Midian departed with the fees for divination in their hand. And they came to Balaam and gave Him Balak's message.
- 8 *And he said unto them, Lodge here this night, and I will bring you word again, as the LORD shall speak unto me: and the princes of Moab abode with Balaam.* he said to them, 'Lodge here tonight. I will bring You word again, as the LORD speaks to me.' So the princes of Moab stayed with Balaam.
- 9 *And God came unto Balaam, and said, What men are these with thee?* God came to Balaam and said, 'Who are these men with You?'

- 10 *And Balaam said unto God, Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, hath sent unto me, saying,* Balaam said to God, 'Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, has sent to me, saying,
- 11 *Behold, there is a people come out of Egypt, which covereth the face of the earth: come now, curse me them; peradventure I shall be able to overcome them, and drive them out.* "There is a people who have come out of Egypt. They cover the face of the earth. Come now, curse them for me. Perhaps I shall be able to fight against them and drive them out."
- 12 *And God said unto Balaam, Thou shalt not go with them; thou shalt not curse the people: for they are blessed.* God said to Balaam, 'You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed.'
- 13 *And Balaam rose up in the morning, and said unto the princes of Balak, Get you into your land: for the LORD refuseth to give me leave to go with you.* So Balaam rose in the morning and said to the princes of Balak, 'Go back to Your own land, for the LORD has refused to let me go with You.'
- 14 *And the princes of Moab rose up, and they went unto Balak, and said, Balaam refuseth to come with us.* So the princes of Moab rose and went to Balak and said, 'Balaam refuses to come with us.'
- 15 *And Balak sent yet again princes, more, and more honourable than they.* Then Balak sent again a larger number of more distinguished officials than these.
- 16 *And they came to Balaam, and said to him, Thus saith Balak the son of Zippor, Let nothing, I pray thee, hinder thee from coming unto me:* they came to Balaam and said to Him, 'Thus says Balak the son of Zippor: "Let nothing hinder You from coming to me,
- 17 *For I will promote thee unto very great honour, and I will do whatsoever thou sayest unto me: come therefore, I pray thee, curse me this people.* for I will surely do You great honor, and whatever You say to me I will do. Come, curse this people for me."

- 18 *And Balaam answered and said unto the servants of Balak, If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot go beyond the word of the LORD my God, to do less or more.* But Balaam answered and said to the servants of Balak, 'Though Balak were to give me His house full of silver and gold, I could not go beyond the command of the LORD my God to do less or more.
- 19 *Now therefore, I pray you, tarry ye also here this night, that I may know what the LORD will say unto me more.* So You, too, please stay here tonight, that I may know what more the LORD will say to me.'
- 20 *And God came unto Balaam at night, and said unto him, If the men come to call thee, rise up, and go with them; but yet the word which I shall say unto thee, that shalt thou do.* God came to Balaam at night and said to Him, 'If the men have come to call You, rise, go with them; but only do what I tell You.'
- 21 *And Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his ass, and went with the princes of Moab.* So Balaam rose in the morning and saddled his donkey and went with the princes of Moab.
- 22 *And God's anger was kindled because he went: and the angel of the LORD stood in the way for an adversary against him. Now he was riding upon his ass, and his two servants were with him.* But God's anger was kindled because He went, and the angel of the LORD took His stand in the road as His adversary. Now He was riding on the donkey. His two servants were with Him.
- 23 *And the ass saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way, and his sword drawn in his hand: and the ass turned aside out of the way, and went into the field: and Balaam smote the ass, to turn her into the way.* the donkey saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road, with a drawn sword in His hand. And the donkey turned aside out of the road and went into the field. And Balaam struck the donkey, to turn her into the road.
- 24 *Then the angel of the LORD stood in a path of the vineyards, a wall being on this side, and a wall on that side.* Then the angel of the LORD stood in a narrow path between the vineyards, with a wall on one side and a wall on the other.

- 25 *And when the ass saw the angel of the LORD, she thrust herself unto the wall, and crushed Balaam's foot against the wall: and he smote her again.* when the donkey saw the angel of the LORD, she pressed against the wall and pressed Balaam's foot against the wall. So He struck her again.
- 26 *And the angel of the LORD went further, and stood in a narrow place, where was no way to turn either to the right hand or to the left.* Then the angel of the LORD went ahead and stood in a narrow place, where there was no way to turn either to the right or to the left.
- 27 *And when the ass saw the angel of the LORD, she fell down under Balaam: and Balaam's anger was kindled, and he smote the ass with a staff.* When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD, she lay down under Balaam. And Balaam's anger was kindled. He struck the donkey with His staff.
- 28 *And the LORD opened the mouth of the ass, and she said unto Balaam, What have I done unto thee, that thou hast smitten me these three times?* Then the LORD opened the mouth of the donkey. She said to Balaam, 'What have I done to you, that you have struck me these three times?'
- 29 *And Balaam said unto the ass, Because thou hast mocked me: I would there were a sword in mine hand, for now would I kill thee.* Balaam said to the donkey, 'Because You have made a fool of me. I wish I had a sword in my hand, for then I would kill You.'
- 30 *And the ass said unto Balaam, Am not I thine ass, upon which thou hast ridden ever since I was thine unto this day? was I ever wont to do so unto thee? And he said, Nay.* the donkey said to Balaam, 'Am I not your donkey, on which you have ridden all your life long to this day? Is it my habit to treat you this way?' And he said, 'No.'
- 31 *Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way, and his sword drawn in his hand: and he bowed down his head, and fell flat on his face.* Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam. He saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road, with His drawn sword in His hand. And He bowed down and fell on His face.

- 32 *And the angel of the LORD said unto him, Wherefore hast thou smitten thine ass these three times? behold, I went out to withstand thee, because thy way is perverse before me:* the angel of the LORD said to Him, 'Why have You struck Your donkey these three times? I have come out to oppose You because Your way is perverse before me.
- 33 *And the ass saw me, and turned from me these three times: unless she had turned from me, surely now also I had slain thee, and saved her alive.* The donkey saw me and turned aside before me these three times. If she had not turned aside from me, surely just now I would have killed You and let her live.'
- 34 *And Balaam said unto the angel of the LORD, I have sinned; for I knew not that thou stoodest in the way against me: now therefore, if it displease thee, I will get me back again.* Then Balaam said to the angel of the LORD, 'I have sinned, for I did not know that You stood in the road against me. Now therefore, if it is evil in Your sight, I will turn back.'
- 35 *And the angel of the LORD said unto Balaam, Go with the men: but only the word that I shall speak unto thee, that thou shalt speak. So Balaam went with the princes of Balak.* the angel of the LORD said to Balaam, 'Go with the men, but speak only the word that I tell you.' So Balaam went on with the princes of Balak.
- 36 *And when Balak heard that Balaam was come, he went out to meet him unto a city of Moab, which is in the border of Arnon, which is in the utmost coast.* When Balak heard that Balaam had come, He went out to meet Him at the city of Moab, on the border formed by the Arnon, at the extremity of the border.
- 37 *And Balak said unto Balaam, Did I not earnestly send unto thee to call thee? wherefore camest thou not unto me? am I not able indeed to promote thee to honour?* Balak said to Balaam, 'Did I not send to you to call you? Why did you not come to me? Am I not able to honor you?'
- 38 *And Balaam said unto Balak, Lo, I am come unto thee: have I now any power at all to say any thing? the word that God putteth in my mouth, that shall I speak.* Balaam said to Balak, 'I have come to you now. Have I any power of my own to speak anything? The word that God puts in my mouth, that must I speak.'

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| <p>39 <i>And Balaam went with Balak, and they came unto Kirjathhuzoth.</i></p> <p>40 <i>And Balak offered oxen and sheep, and sent to Balaam, and to the princes that were with him.</i></p> <p>41 <i>And it came to pass on the morrow, that Balak took Balaam, and brought him up into the high places of Baal, that thence he might see the utmost part of the people.</i></p> | <p>Then Balaam went with Balak. They came to Kiriath-huzoth.</p> <p>Balak sacrificed oxen and sheep, and sent some to Balaam and to the princes who were with Him.</p> <p>on the next day Balak took Balaam and brought Him up to Bamoth-baal, and from there He could see the nearest portion of the people.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Balak (*BAY-lak*) — King of Moab who hired Balaam to curse Israel — his name means 'devastator'; he feared Israel after their defeat of the Amorites.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

v2 — Judg 11:25

v3 — Ex 15:15

v5 — Deut 23:4; Josh 24:9; Mic 6:5

v12 — Deut 23:5; Eph 1:3; Rom 11:29; Num 23:19-20; Gen 12:2

v18 — Num 24:13; 2 Chr 18:13; 1 Kgs 22:14

v20 — Num 24:13; Num 23:26; Num 23:12; Num 22:35

v22 — Num 22:32; Ex 4:24; Lam 2:4

v28 — 2 Pet 2:16; Ex 4:11; Luke 1:37

v29 — Prov 12:10

v31 — Gen 21:19; Luke 24:31

v34 — Job 34:31-32; 1 Sam 15:24

Chapter 23

Balak brings Balaam to three different high places to curse Israel, but each time the LORD puts a blessing in Balaam's mouth instead. Balaam declares that God is not a man that He should lie, and that He has blessed Israel and cannot reverse it.

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| <p>1 <i>And Balaam said unto Balak, Build me here seven altars, and prepare me here seven oxen and seven rams.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And Balak did as Balaam had spoken; and Balak and Balaam offered on every altar a bullock and a ram.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And Balaam said unto Balak, Stand by thy burnt offering, and I will go: peradventure the LORD will come to meet me: and whatsoever he sheweth me I will tell thee. And he went to an high place.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And God met Balaam: and he said unto him, I have prepared seven altars, and I have offered upon every altar a bullock and a ram.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And the LORD put a word in Balaam's mouth, and said, Return unto Balak, and thus thou shalt speak.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And he returned unto him, and, lo, he stood by his burnt sacrifice, he, and all the princes of Moab.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And he took up his parable, and said, Balak the king of Moab hath brought me from Aram, out of the mountains of the east, saying, Come, curse me Jacob, and come, defy Israel.</i></p> <p>8 <i>How shall I curse, whom God hath not cursed? or how shall I defy, whom the LORD hath not defied?</i></p> | <p>Balaam said to Balak, 'Build for me here seven altars, and prepare for me here seven bulls and seven rams.'</p> <p>Balak did as Balaam said. And Balak and Balaam offered on each altar a bull and a ram.</p> <p>Balaam said to Balak, 'Stand beside your burnt offering. I will go. Perhaps the LORD will come to meet me, and whatever he shows me I will tell you.' And he went to a bare height.</p> <p>God met Balaam, and Balaam said to Him, 'I have arranged the seven altars and have offered on each altar a bull and a ram.'</p> <p>the LORD put a word in Balaam's mouth and said, 'Return to Balak, and thus you shall speak.'</p> <p>he returned to Him, and there He was, standing beside His burnt offering, He and all the princes of Moab.</p> <p>Balaam took up his discourse and said, 'From Aram Balak has brought me, the king of Moab from the eastern mountains: "Come, curse Jacob for me, and come, denounce Israel!"</p> <p>How can I curse whom God has not cursed? How can I denounce whom the LORD has not denounced?</p> |
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- 9 *For from the top of the rocks I see him, and from the hills I behold him: lo, the people shall dwell alone, and shall not be reckoned among the nations.* For from the top of the crags I see Him, from the hills I see Him; a people dwelling alone, and not counting itself among the nations.
- 10 *Who can count the dust of Jacob, and the number of the fourth part of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous, and let my last end be like his!* Who can count the dust of Jacob or number the fourth part of Israel? Let me die the death of the upright, and let my end be like his!
- 11 *And Balak said unto Balaam, What hast thou done unto me? I took thee to curse mine enemies, and, behold, thou hast blessed them altogether.* Balak said to Balaam, 'What have you done to me? I took you to curse my enemies, and here you have done nothing but bless them.'
- 12 *And he answered and said, Must I not take heed to speak that which the LORD hath put in my mouth?* he answered and said, 'Must I not take care to speak what the LORD puts in my mouth?'
- 13 *And Balak said unto him, Come, I pray thee, with me unto another place, from whence thou mayest see them: thou shalt see but the utmost part of them, and shalt not see them all: and curse me them from thence.* Balak said to Him, 'Please come with me to another place, from which You may see them. You shall see only a portion of them and shall not see them all. Then curse them for me from there.'
- 14 *And he brought him into the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars, and offered a bullock and a ram on every altar.* he took Him to the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars and offered a bull and a ram on each altar.
- 15 *And he said unto Balak, Stand here by thy burnt offering, while I meet the LORD yonder.* Balaam said to Balak, 'Stand here beside your burnt offering, while I meet the LORD over there.'
- 16 *And the LORD met Balaam, and put a word in his mouth, and said, Go again unto Balak, and say thus.* the LORD met Balaam and put a word in his mouth and said, 'Return to Balak, and thus shall you speak.'

- 17 *And he came to him, and, lo, he stood by his burnt offering, and the princes of Moab with him. And Balak said unto him, What hath the LORD spoken?* he came to Him, and there He was, standing beside His burnt offering, and the princes of Moab with Him. And Balak said to Him, 'What has the LORD spoken?'
- 18 *And he took up his parable, and said, Rise up, Balak, and hear; hearken unto me, thou son of Zippor:* Balaam took up His discourse and said, 'Rise, Balak, and hear; give ear to me, O son of Zippor.
- 19 *God is not a man, that he should lie; neither the son of man, that he should repent: hath he said, and shall he not do it? or hath he spoken, and shall he not make it good?* God is not man, that He should lie, or a son of man, that He should change His mind. Has He said, and will He not do it? Or has He spoken, and will He not fulfill it?
- 20 *Behold, I have received commandment to bless: and he hath blessed; and I cannot reverse it.* I have received a command to bless; He has blessed. I cannot revoke it.
- 21 *He hath not beheld iniquity in Jacob, neither hath he seen perverseness in Israel: the LORD his God is with him, and the shout of a king is among them.* He has not observed misfortune in Jacob, nor has he seen trouble in Israel. The LORD their God is with them, and the shout of a king is among them.
- 22 *God brought them out of Egypt; he hath as it were the strength of an unicorn.* God brings them out of Egypt and is for them like the strength of a unicorn.
- 23 *Surely there is no enchantment against Jacob, neither is there any divination against Israel: according to this time it shall be said of Jacob and of Israel, What hath God wrought!* For there is no enchantment against Jacob, no divination against Israel; now it shall be said of Jacob and Israel, "What has God done!"
- 24 *Behold, the people shall rise up as a great lion, and lift up himself as a young lion: he shall not lie down until he eat of the prey, and drink the blood of the slain.* A people rises like a lioness; it rouses itself like a lion — it does not lie down until it has devoured the prey and drunk the blood of the slain.'

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| 25 | <i>And Balak said unto Balaam, Neither curse them at all, nor bless them at all.</i> | Then Balak said to Balaam, 'Do not curse them at all, and do not bless them at all.' |
| 26 | <i>But Balaam answered and said unto Balak, Told not I thee, saying, All that the LORD speaketh, that I must do?</i> | But Balaam answered Balak, 'Did I not tell you, "All that the LORD speaks, that I must do"?'' |
| 27 | <i>And Balak said unto Balaam, Come, I pray thee, I will bring thee unto another place; peradventure it will please God that thou mayest curse me them from thence.</i> | Balak said to Balaam, 'Come now, I will take you to another place. Perhaps it will please God that you may curse them for me from there.' |
| 28 | <i>And Balak brought Balaam unto the top of Peor, that looketh toward Jeshimon.</i> | So Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor, which overlooks the desert. |
| 29 | <i>And Balaam said unto Balak, Build me here seven altars, and prepare me here seven bullocks and seven rams.</i> | Balaam said to Balak, 'Build for me here seven altars, and prepare for me here seven bulls and seven rams.' |
| 30 | <i>And Balak did as Balaam had said, and offered a bullock and a ram on every altar.</i> | Balak did as Balaam had said, and offered a bull and a ram on each altar. |

Words in this chapter:

unicorn — KJV translation of the Hebrew *re'em* — a powerful, wild, one-horned animal; likely the aurochs (a now-extinct wild ox), presented as untameable.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

v5 — Deut 18:18; Jer 1:9

v7 — Num 22:5-6; Num 23:18; Deut 23:4; Num 24:3

v8 — Num 23:23; Num 23:20; Isa 44:25; Num 22:12

v9 — Deut 33:28; Deut 32:8; Ex 33:16

v10 — Ps 37:37; Gen 13:16; Ps 116:15; Rev 14:13

v11 — Neh 13:2; Num 24:10

v19 — 1 Sam 15:29; Jas 1:17; Heb 6:18; Mal 3:6; Titus 1:2

v20 — John 10:27-29; Num 22:12; Gen 12:2; Gen 22:17; Isa 43:13

v21 — Ps 23:4; Matt 1:23; Jer 50:20; Rom 4:7-8; Ex 29:45-46

v22 — Num 24:8; Deut 33:17

v23 — Luke 10:18-19; Josh 13:22; Ps 64:9; Rom 16:20; Num 24:1

v24 — Gen 49:27; Gen 49:9

Chapter 24

Balaam speaks two more oracles blessing Israel, prophesying that a star shall come out of Jacob and a scepter shall rise out of Israel. He then pronounces oracles against Moab, Amalek, the Kenites, and Assyria before returning home.

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| 1 | <i>And when Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he went not, as at other times, to seek for enchantments, but he set his face toward the wilderness.</i> | When Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, He did not go, as at other times, to look for omens, but set His face toward the wilderness. |
| 2 | <i>And Balaam lifted up his eyes, and he saw Israel abiding in his tents according to their tribes; and the spirit of God came upon him.</i> | Balaam lifted up His eyes and saw Israel camping tribe by tribe. And the Spirit of God came upon Him, |
| 3 | <i>And he took up his parable, and said, Balaam the son of Beor hath said, and the man whose eyes are open hath said:</i> | he took up his discourse and said, 'The oracle of Balaam the son of Beor, the oracle of the man whose eye is opened, |
| 4 | <i>He hath said, which heard the words of God, which saw the vision of the Almighty, falling into a trance, but having his eyes open:</i> | the oracle of Him who hears the words of God, Who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down with His eyes uncovered: |
| 5 | <i>How goodly are thy tents, O Jacob, and thy tabernacles, O Israel!</i> | How lovely are your tents, O Jacob, your encampments, O Israel! |
| 6 | <i>As the valleys are they spread forth, as gardens by the river's side, as the trees of lign aloes which the LORD hath planted, and as cedar trees beside the waters.</i> | Like palm groves that stretch out, like gardens beside a river, like aloes that the LORD has planted, like cedar trees beside the waters. |

- 7 *He shall pour the water out of his buckets, and his seed shall be in many waters, and his king shall be higher than Agag, and his kingdom shall be exalted.* Water shall flow from His buckets. His seed shall be in many waters; His king shall be higher than Agag. His kingdom shall be exalted.
- 8 *God brought him forth out of Egypt; he hath as it were the strength of an unicorn: he shall eat up the nations his enemies, and shall break their bones, and pierce them through with his arrows.* God brings Him out of Egypt and is for Him like the strength of a unicorn; He shall devour the nations, his adversaries, and shall break their bones in pieces and pierce them through with his arrows.
- 9 *He couched, he lay down as a lion, and as a great lion: who shall stir him up? Blessed is he that blesseth thee, and cursed is he that curseth thee.* He crouched, He lay down like a lion and like a lioness; who will rouse Him up? Blessed are those who bless You, and cursed are those who curse You.'
- 10 *And Balak's anger was kindled against Balaam, and he smote his hands together: and Balak said unto Balaam, I called thee to curse mine enemies, and, behold, thou hast altogether blessed them these three times.* Balak's anger was kindled against Balaam. He struck his hands together. And Balak said to Balaam, 'I called you to curse my enemies, and you have blessed them these three times.
- 11 *Therefore now flee thou to thy place: I thought to promote thee unto great honour; but, lo, the LORD hath kept thee back from honour.* Therefore now flee to Your own place. I said I would greatly honor You. But The LORD has held You back from honor.'
- 12 *And Balaam said unto Balak, Spake I not also to thy messengers which thou sentest unto me, saying,* Balaam said to Balak, 'Did I not tell your messengers whom you sent to me,
- 13 *If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot go beyond the commandment of the LORD, to do either good or bad of mine own mind; but what the LORD saith, that will I speak?* "If Balak should give me His house full of silver and gold, I would not be able to go beyond the word of the LORD, to do either good or bad of my own will. What the LORD speaks, that will I speak"?

- 14 *And now, behold, I go unto my people: come therefore, and I will advertise thee what this people shall do to thy people in the latter days.* now, I am going to my people. Come, I will let You know what this people will do to Your people in the latter days.'
- 15 *And he took up his parable, and said, Balaam the son of Beor hath said, and the man whose eyes are open hath said:* he took up his discourse and said, 'The oracle of Balaam the son of Beor, the oracle of the man whose eye is opened,
- 16 *He hath said, which heard the words of God, and knew the knowledge of the most High, which saw the vision of the Almighty, falling into a trance, but having his eyes open:* the oracle of Him who hears the words of God, and knows the knowledge of the Most High, Who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down with His eyes uncovered:
- 17 *I shall see him, but not now: I shall behold him, but not nigh: there shall come a Star out of Jacob, and a Sceptre shall rise out of Israel, and shall smite the corners of Moab, and destroy all the children of Sheth.* I see him, but not now; I view him, but not near: a star shall come out of Jacob, and a scepter shall rise out of Israel; it shall crush the forehead of Moab and break down all the sons of Sheth.
- 18 *And Edom shall be a possession, Seir also shall be a possession for his enemies; and Israel shall do valiantly.* Edom shall be dispossessed; Seir also, his enemies, shall be dispossessed. Israel is doing valiantly.
- 19 *Out of Jacob shall come he that shall have dominion, and shall destroy him that remaineth of the city.* one from Jacob shall exercise dominion and destroy the survivors of cities!'
- 20 *And when he looked on Amalek, he took up his parable, and said, Amalek was the first of the nations; but his latter end shall be that he perish for ever.* Then he looked on Amalek and took up his discourse and said, 'Amalek was the first among the nations, but its end is destruction.'
- 21 *And he looked on the Kenites, and took up his parable, and said, Strong is thy dwelling place, and thou puttest thy nest in a rock.* he looked on the Kenite and took up his discourse and said, 'Enduring is your dwelling place, and your nest is set in the rock.

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| 22 | <i>Nevertheless the Kenite shall be wasted, until Asshur shall carry thee away captive.</i> | Nevertheless, the Kenite shall be wasted when Asshur takes you away captive.' |
| 23 | <i>And he took up his parable, and said, Alas, who shall live when God doeth this!</i> | he took up his discourse and said, 'Alas, who shall live when God does this? |
| 24 | <i>And ships shall come from the coast of Chittim, and shall afflict Asshur, and shall afflict Eber, and he also shall perish for ever.</i> | But ships shall come from Kittim and shall afflict Asshur and Eber. He too shall come to destruction.' |
| 25 | <i>And Balaam rose up, and went and returned to his place: and Balak also went his way.</i> | Then Balaam rose and went back to his place. And Balak also went his way. |

Words in this chapter:

advertise — To inform or advise — in the KJV, 'I will advertise thee' means 'I will tell you' or 'I will give you counsel.'

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Sam 19:20
- v4 — Rev 1:17
- v6 — Ps 1:3
- v7 — 2 Sam 5:12
- v8 — Ps 45:5; Ps 2:9; Num 14:9; Num 23:22; Num 23:24
- v9 — Gen 12:3; Gen 27:29; Gen 49:9; Num 23:24
- v10 — Num 23:11; Ezek 21:14; Ezek 21:17; Ezek 22:13
- v14 — Mic 6:5
- v17 — Rev 22:16; Luke 1:32-33; Gen 49:10; Rev 11:15; Rev 1:7
- v18 — Amos 9:12
- v24 — Gen 10:4

Chapter 25

Israel commits whoredom with the daughters of Moab and worships Baal of Peor, provoking the LORD's anger. A plague kills 24,000 before Phinehas the priest drives a spear through an Israelite man and a Midianite woman; the LORD rewards Phinehas with a covenant of everlasting priesthood.

- 1 *And Israel abode in Shittim, and the people began to commit whoredom with the daughters of Moab.* While Israel lived in Shittim, the people began to whore with the daughters of Moab.
- 2 *And they called the people unto the sacrifices of their gods: and the people did eat, and bowed down to their gods.* These women invited the people to the sacrifices of their gods, and the people ate and bowed down to their gods.
- 3 *And Israel joined himself unto Baalpeor: and the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel.* So Israel yoked Himself to Baal of Peor. And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel.
- 4 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Take all the heads of the people, and hang them up before the LORD against the sun, that the fierce anger of the LORD may be turned away from Israel.* the LORD said to Moses, 'Take all the chiefs of the people and hang them before the LORD in the sun, that the fierce anger of the LORD may turn away from Israel.'
- 5 *And Moses said unto the judges of Israel, Slay ye every one his men that were joined unto Baalpeor.* Moses said to the judges of Israel, 'Each of you kill those of his men who have yoked themselves to Baal of Peor.'
- 6 *And, behold, one of the children of Israel came and brought unto his brethren a Midianitish woman in the sight of Moses, and in the sight of all the congregation of the children of Israel, who were weeping before the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* just then, one of the people of Israel came and brought a Midianite woman to his family, in the sight of Moses and in the sight of the whole congregation of the people of Israel, while they were weeping in the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 7 *And when Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, saw it, he rose up from among the congregation, and took a javelin in his hand;* When Phinehas the son of Eleazar, son of Aaron the priest, saw it, he rose and left the congregation and took a spear in his hand

- 8 *And he went after the man of Israel into the tent, and thrust both of them through, the man of Israel, and the woman through her belly. So the plague was stayed from the children of Israel.* went after the man of Israel into the inner room and pierced both of them, the man of Israel and the woman through her belly. So the plague on the people of Israel was stopped.
- 9 *And those that died in the plague were twenty and four thousand.* Nevertheless those who died by the plague were 24,000.
- 10 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 11 *Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, hath turned my wrath away from the children of Israel, while he was zealous for my sake among them, that I consumed not the children of Israel in my jealousy.* 'Phinehas the son of Eleazar, son of Aaron the priest, has turned back my wrath from the people of Israel, in that he was jealous with my jealousy among them, so that I did not consume the people of Israel in my jealousy.
- 12 *Wherefore say, Behold, I give unto him my covenant of peace:* Therefore say, "I am giving him my covenant of peace,
- 13 *And he shall have it, and his seed after him, even the covenant of an everlasting priesthood; because he was zealous for his God, and made an atonement for the children of Israel.* it shall be to him and to his descendants after him the covenant of a perpetual priesthood, because he was jealous for his God and made atonement for the people of Israel."
- 14 *Now the name of the Israelite that was slain, even that was slain with the Midianitish woman, was Zimri, the son of Salu, a prince of a chief house among the Simeonites.* The name of the slain man of Israel, who was killed with the Midianite woman, was Zimri the son of Salu, a chief of a fathers' house belonging to the Simeonites.
- 15 *And the name of the Midianitish woman that was slain was Cozbi, the daughter of Zur; he was head over a people, and of a chief house in Midian.* the name of the Midianite woman who was killed was Cozbi the daughter of Zur, who was the head of a clan, a chief's house in Midian.

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| <p>16 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i></p> <p>17 <i>Vex the Midianites, and smite them:</i></p> <p>18 <i>For they vex you with their wives, wherewith they have beguiled you in the matter of Peor, and in the matter of Cozbi, the daughter of a prince of Midian, their sister, which was slain in the day of the plague for Peor's sake.</i></p> | <p>the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,</p> <p>'Harass the Midianites and strike them down,</p> <p>for they have harassed You with their wives, with which they beguiled You in the matter of Peor, and in the matter of Cozbi, the daughter of the chief of Midian, their sister, who was killed on the day of the plague on account of Peor.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Midianites (*MID-ee-an-ytes*) — A nomadic people descended from Abraham's son Midian — Moses fled to Midian; the Midianites oppressed Israel for seven years before Gideon defeated them.

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 10:8; Josh 2:1; Num 33:49
- v2 — 1 Cor 10:20; Ex 20:5; Ex 34:15-16
- v3 — Ps 106:28-29; Josh 22:17; Hos 9:10
- v4 — Deut 13:17
- v8 — Num 16:46-48
- v9 — 1 Cor 10:8
- v11 — Ps 78:58; Deut 32:16; Deut 32:21
- v12 — Mal 2:4-5
- v13 — Heb 2:17
- v15 — Num 31:8

Chapter 26

After the plague, the LORD commands a second census of all men twenty years old and older who are able to go to war. The total count is 601,730 -- nearly the same as the first census. Not one man counted in the first census at Sinai remains alive except Caleb and Joshua.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass after the plague, that the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, saying,</i> | After the plague the LORD said to Moses and to Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, |
| 2 | <i>Take the sum of all the congregation of the children of Israel, from twenty years old and upward, throughout their fathers' house, all that are able to go to war in Israel.</i> | 'Take a census of all the congregation of the people of Israel, from twenty years old and upward, by their fathers' houses, all in Israel who are able to go to war.' |
| 3 | <i>And Moses and Eleazar the priest spake with them in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, saying,</i> | Moses and Eleazar the priest spoke with them in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying, |
| 4 | <i>Take the sum of the people, from twenty years old and upward; as the LORD commanded Moses and the children of Israel, which went forth out of the land of Egypt.</i> | 'Take a census of the people, from twenty years old and upward,' as the LORD commanded Moses. The people of Israel who came out of the land of Egypt were: |
| 5 | <i>Reuben, the eldest son of Israel: the children of Reuben; Hanoch, of whom cometh the family of the Hanochites: of Pallu, the family of the Palluites:</i> | Reuben, the firstborn of Israel; the sons of Reuben: of Hanoch, the clan of the Hanochites; of Pallu, the clan of the Palluites; |
| 6 | <i>Of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites: of Carmi, the family of the Carmites.</i> | of Hezron, the clan of the Hezronites; of Carmi, the clan of the Carmites. |
| 7 | <i>These are the families of the Reubenites: and they that were numbered of them were forty and three thousand and seven hundred and thirty.</i> | These are the clans of the Reubenites, and those listed were 43,730. |
| 8 | <i>And the sons of Pallu; Eliab.</i> | the sons of Pallu: Eliab. |

- 9 *And the sons of Eliab; Nemuel, and Dathan, and Abiram. This is that Dathan and Abiram, which were famous in the congregation, who strove against Moses and against Aaron in the company of Korah, when they strove against the LORD:* The sons of Eliab: Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. These are the Dathan and Abiram, chosen from the congregation, who contended against Moses and Aaron in the company of Korah, when they contended against the LORD
- 10 *And the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up together with Korah, when that company died, what time the fire devoured two hundred and fifty men: and they became a sign.* the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up together with Korah, when that company died, when the fire devoured 250 men. They became a warning.
- 11 *Notwithstanding the children of Korah died not.* But the sons of Korah did not die.
- 12 *The sons of Simeon after their families: of Nemuel, the family of the Nemuelites: of Jamin, the family of the Jaminites: of Jachin, the family of the Jachinites:* The sons of Simeon according to their clans: of Nemuel, the clan of the Nemuelites; of Jamin, the clan of the Jaminites; of Jachin, the clan of the Jachinites;
- 13 *Of Zerah, the family of the Zarhites: of Shaul, the family of the Shaulites.* of Zerah, the clan of the Zerahites; of Shaul, the clan of the Shaulites.
- 14 *These are the families of the Simeonites, twenty and two thousand and two hundred.* These are the clans of the Simeonites, 22,200.
- 15 *The children of Gad after their families: of Zephon, the family of the Zephonites: of Haggi, the family of the Haggites: of Shuni, the family of the Shunites:* The sons of Gad according to their clans: of Zephon, the clan of the Zephonites; of Haggi, the clan of the Haggites; of Shuni, the clan of the Shunites;
- 16 *Of Ozni, the family of the Oznites: of Eri, the family of the Erites:* of Ozni, the clan of the Oznites; of Eri, the clan of the Erites;
- 17 *Of Arod, the family of the Arodites: of Areli, the family of the Arelites.* of Arod, the clan of the Arodites; of Areli, the clan of the Arelites.

- 18 *These are the families of the children of Gad according to those that were numbered of them, forty thousand and five hundred.* These are the clans of the sons of Gad as listed, 40,500.
- 19 *The sons of Judah were Er and Onan: and Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan.* The sons of Judah were Er and Onan. Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan.
- 20 *And the sons of Judah after their families were; of Shelah, the family of the Shelanites: of Pharez, the family of the Pharzites: of Zerah, the family of the Zarhites.* the sons of Judah according to their clans were: of Shelah, the clan of the Shelanites; of Perez, the clan of the Perezites; of Zerah, the clan of the Zerahites.
- 21 *And the sons of Pharez were; of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites: of Hamul, the family of the Hamulites.* the sons of Perez were: of Hezron, the clan of the Hezronites; of Hamul, the clan of the Hamulites.
- 22 *These are the families of Judah according to those that were numbered of them, threescore and sixteen thousand and five hundred.* These are the clans of Judah as listed, 76,500.
- 23 *Of the sons of Issachar after their families: of Tola, the family of the Tolaites: of Pua, the family of the Punites;* The sons of Issachar according to their clans: of Tola, the clan of the Tolaites; of Puvah, the clan of the Punites;
- 24 *Of Jashub, the family of the Jashubites: of Shimron, the family of the Shimronites.* of Jashub, the clan of the Jashubites; of Shimron, the clan of the Shimronites.
- 25 *These are the families of Issachar according to those that were numbered of them, threescore and four thousand and three hundred.* These are the clans of Issachar as listed, 64,300.

- 26 *Of the sons of Zebulun after their families: of Sered, the family of the Sardites: of Elon, the family of the Elonites: of Jahleel, the family of the Jahleelites.* The sons of Zebulun according to their clans: of Sered, the clan of the Seredites; of Elon, the clan of the Elonites; of Jahleel, the clan of the Jahleelites.
- 27 *These are the families of the Zebulunites according to those that were numbered of them, threescore thousand and five hundred.* These are the clans of the Zebulunites as listed, 60,500.
- 28 *The sons of Joseph after their families were Manasseh and Ephraim.* The sons of Joseph according to their clans: Manasseh and Ephraim.
- 29 *Of the sons of Manasseh: of Machir, the family of the Machirites: and Machir begat Gilead: of Gilead come the family of the Gileadites.* The sons of Manasseh: of Machir, the clan of the Machirites. Machir begat Gilead; of Gilead, the clan of the Gileadites.
- 30 *These are the sons of Gilead: of Jeezer, the family of the Jeezerites: of Helek, the family of the Helekites:* These are the sons of Gilead: of Iezer, the clan of the Iezerites; of Helek, the clan of the Helekites;
- 31 *And of Asriel, the family of the Asrielites: and of Shechem, the family of the Shechemites:* of Asriel, the clan of the Asrielites. Of Shechem, the clan of the Shechemites;
- 32 *And of Shemida, the family of the Shemidaites: and of Hephher, the family of the Hephherites.* of Shemida, the clan of the Shemidaites. Of Hephher, the clan of the Hephherites.
- 33 *And Zelophehad the son of Hephher had no sons, but daughters: and the names of the daughters of Zelophehad were Mahlah, and Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.* Now Zelophehad the son of Hephher had no sons, but daughters. And the names of the daughters of Zelophehad were Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.
- 34 *These are the families of Manasseh, and those that were numbered of them, fifty and two thousand and seven hundred.* These are the clans of Manasseh, and those listed were 52,700.

- 35 *These are the sons of Ephraim after their families: of Shuthelah, the family of the Shuthelahites: of Becher, the family of the Bachrites: of Tahan, the family of the Tahanites.* These are the sons of Ephraim according to their clans: of Shuthelah, the clan of the Shuthelahites; of Becher, the clan of the Becherites; of Tahan, the clan of the Tahanites.
- 36 *And these are the sons of Shuthelah: of Eran, the family of the Eranites.* these are the sons of Shuthelah: of Eran, the clan of the Eranites.
- 37 *These are the families of the sons of Ephraim according to those that were numbered of them, thirty and two thousand and five hundred. These are the sons of Joseph after their families.* These are the clans of the sons of Ephraim as listed, 32,500. These are the sons of Joseph according to their clans.
- 38 *The sons of Benjamin after their families: of Bela, the family of the Belaïtes: of Ashbel, the family of the Ashbelites: of Ahiram, the family of the Ahiramites:* The sons of Benjamin according to their clans: of Bela, the clan of the Belaïtes; of Ashbel, the clan of the Ashbelites; of Ahiram, the clan of the Ahiramites;
- 39 *Of Shupham, the family of the Shuphamites: of Hupham, the family of the Huphamites.* of Shephupham, the clan of the Shephuphamites; of Hupham, the clan of the Huphamites.
- 40 *And the sons of Bela were Ard and Naaman: of Ard, the family of the Ardites: and of Naaman, the family of the Naamites.* the sons of Bela were Ard and Naaman: of Ard, the clan of the Ardites; of Naaman, the clan of the Naamites.
- 41 *These are the sons of Benjamin after their families: and they that were numbered of them were forty and five thousand and six hundred.* These are the sons of Benjamin according to their clans, and those listed were 45,600.
- 42 *These are the sons of Dan after their families: of Shuham, the family of the Shuhamites. These are the families of Dan after their families.* These are the sons of Dan according to their clans: of Shuham, the clan of the Shuhamites. These are the clans of Dan according to their clans.

- 43 *All the families of the Shuhamites, according to those that were numbered of them, were threescore and four thousand and four hundred.* All the clans of the Shuhamites, as listed, were 64,400.
- 44 *Of the children of Asher after their families: of Jimna, the family of the Jimnites: of Jesui, the family of the Jesuites: of Beriah, the family of the Beriites.* The sons of Asher according to their clans: of Imnah, the clan of the Imnites; of Ishvi, the clan of the Ishvites; of Beriah, the clan of the Beriites.
- 45 *Of the sons of Beriah: of Heber, the family of the Heberites: of Malchiel, the family of the Malchielites.* Of the sons of Beriah: of Heber, the clan of the Heberites; of Malchiel, the clan of the Malchielites.
- 46 *And the name of the daughter of Asher was Sarah.* the name of the daughter of Asher was Serah.
- 47 *These are the families of the sons of Asher according to those that were numbered of them; who were fifty and three thousand and four hundred.* These are the clans of the sons of Asher as listed, 53,400.
- 48 *Of the sons of Naphtali after their families: of Jahzeel, the family of the Jahzeelites: of Guni, the family of the Gunites:* The sons of Naphtali according to their clans: of Jahzeel, the clan of the Jahzeelites; of Guni, the clan of the Gunites;
- 49 *Of Jezer, the family of the Jezerites: of Shillem, the family of the Shillemites.* of Jezer, the clan of the Jezerites; of Shillem, the clan of the Shillemites.
- 50 *These are the families of Naphtali according to their families: and they that were numbered of them were forty and five thousand and four hundred.* These are the clans of Naphtali according to their clans, and those listed were 45,400.
- 51 *These were the numbered of the children of Israel, six hundred thousand and a thousand seven hundred and thirty.* These were the listed people of Israel, 601,730.

- 52 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 53 *Unto these the land shall be divided for an inheritance according to the number of names.* 'Among these the land shall be divided for inheritance according to the number of names.
- 54 *To many thou shalt give the more inheritance, and to few thou shalt give the less inheritance: to every one shall his inheritance be given according to those that were numbered of him.* To a large tribe You shall give a large inheritance, and to a small tribe You shall give a small inheritance; every tribe shall be given its inheritance in proportion to its list.
- 55 *Notwithstanding the land shall be divided by lot: according to the names of the tribes of their fathers they shall inherit.* But the land shall be divided by lot. According to the names of the tribes of their fathers they shall inherit.
- 56 *According to the lot shall the possession thereof be divided between many and few.* Their inheritance shall be divided according to lot between the larger and the smaller.'
- 57 *And these are they that were numbered of the Levites after their families: of Gershon, the family of the Gershonites: of Kohath, the family of the Kohathites: of Merari, the family of the Merarites.* These are those listed of the Levites according to their clans: of Gershon, the clan of the Gershonites; of Kohath, the clan of the Kohathites; of Merari, the clan of the Merarites.
- 58 *These are the families of the Levites: the family of the Libnites, the family of the Hebronites, the family of the Mahlites, the family of the Mushites, the family of the Korathites. And Kohath begat Amram.* These are the clans of Levi: the clan of the Libnites, the clan of the Hebronites, the clan of the Mahlites, the clan of the Mushites, the clan of the Korahites. And Kohath begat Amram.
- 59 *And the name of Amram's wife was Jochebed, the daughter of Levi, whom her mother bare to Levi in Egypt: and she bare unto Amram Aaron and Moses, and Miriam their sister.* The name of Amram's wife was Jochebed the daughter of Levi, who was born to Levi in Egypt. And she bore to Amram Aaron and Moses and Miriam their sister.

- 60 *And unto Aaron was born Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.* to Aaron were born Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.
- 61 *And Nadab and Abihu died, when they offered strange fire before the LORD.* But Nadab and Abihu died when they offered unauthorized fire before the LORD.
- 62 *And those that were numbered of them were twenty and three thousand, all males from a month old and upward: for they were not numbered among the children of Israel, because there was no inheritance given them among the children of Israel.* those listed were 23,000, every male from a month old and upward. For they were not listed among the people of Israel, because there was no inheritance given to them among the people of Israel.
- 63 *These are they that were numbered by Moses and Eleazar the priest, who numbered the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.* These are those listed by Moses and Eleazar the priest, who listed the people of Israel in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.
- 64 *But among these there was not a man of them whom Moses and Aaron the priest numbered, when they numbered the children of Israel in the wilderness of Sinai.* But among these there was not one of those listed by Moses and Aaron the priest, when they had listed the people of Israel in the wilderness of Sinai.
- 65 *For the LORD had said of them, They shall surely die in the wilderness. And there was not left a man of them, save Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.* For the LORD had said of them, 'They shall die in the wilderness.' And not one of them was left, except Caleb the son of Jephunneh and Joshua the son of Nun.

Words in this chapter:

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Noah (NO-ah) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Pharez (FAIR-ez) — Twin son of Judah and Tamar — ancestor of King David and of Jesus; his name means 'breach' because he broke out first from the womb unexpectedly.

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 25:9
- v2 — Ex 38:25-26
- v3 — Num 22:1
- v10 — Num 16:38
- v23 — 1 Chr 7:1; Gen 46:13
- v48 — Gen 46:24; 1 Chr 7:13
- v55 — Num 34:13; Num 33:54
- v59 — Ex 6:20; Ex 2:1-2
- v61 — Lev 10:1-2; Num 3:4
- v62 — Num 1:49; Num 35:2-8; Num 3:39; Deut 10:9
- v64 — Deut 2:14-15
- v65 — 1 Cor 10:5-6; Num 14:38; Rom 11:22

Chapter 27

The daughters of Zelophehad successfully petition Moses for an inheritance in the Promised Land since their father died without sons, and the LORD establishes the law of inheritance for all Israel. The LORD tells Moses to go up Mount Abarim and see the land, then commissions Joshua the son of Nun as Moses's successor.

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| 1 <i>Then came the daughters of Zelophehad, the son of Hephher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of Manasseh the son of Joseph: and these are the names of his daughters; Mahlah, Noah, and Hoglah, and Milcah, and Tirzah.</i> | Then drew near the daughters of Zelophehad the son of Hephher, son of Gilead, son of Machir, son of Manasseh, from the clans of Manasseh the son of Joseph. These are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. |
| 2 <i>And they stood before Moses, and before Eleazar the priest, and before the princes and all the congregation, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, saying,</i> | they stood before Moses and before Eleazar the priest and before the chiefs and all the congregation, at the entrance of the tent of meeting, saying, |

- 3 *Our father died in the wilderness, and he was not in the company of them that gathered themselves together against the LORD in the company of Korah; but died in his own sin, and had no sons.* 'Our father died in the wilderness. He was not among the company of those who gathered themselves together against the LORD in the company of Korah, but died for His own sin. And He had no sons.
- 4 *Why should the name of our father be done away from among his family, because he hath no son? Give unto us therefore a possession among the brethren of our father.* Why should the name of our father be taken away from His clan because He had no son? Give to us a possession among our father's brothers.'
- 5 *And Moses brought their cause before the LORD.* Moses brought their case before the LORD.
- 6 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD said to Moses,
- 7 *The daughters of Zelophehad speak right: thou shalt surely give them a possession of an inheritance among their father's brethren; and thou shalt cause the inheritance of their father to pass unto them.* 'The daughters of Zelophehad are right. You shall give them possession of an inheritance among their father's brothers and transfer the inheritance of their father to them.
- 8 *And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, If a man die, and have no son, then ye shall cause his inheritance to pass unto his daughter.* you shall speak to the people of Israel, saying, "If a man dies and has no son, then you shall transfer His inheritance to His daughter.
- 9 *And if he have no daughter, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his brethren.* if He has no daughter, then You shall give His inheritance to His brothers.
- 10 *And if he have no brethren, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his father's brethren.* if He has no brothers, then You shall give His inheritance to His father's brothers.

- 11 *And if his father have no brethren, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his kinsman that is next to him of his family, and he shall possess it: and it shall be unto the children of Israel a statute of judgment, as the LORD commanded Moses.* if His father has no brothers, then You shall give His inheritance to the nearest kinsman of His clan. He shall possess it. And it shall be for the people of Israel a statute and rule, as the LORD commanded Moses."
- 12 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Get thee up into this mount Abarim, and see the land which I have given unto the children of Israel.* The LORD said to Moses, 'Go up into this mountain of Abarim and see the land that I have given to the people of Israel.
- 13 *And when thou hast seen it, thou also shalt be gathered unto thy people, as Aaron thy brother was gathered.* When you have seen it, you also shall be gathered to your people, as your brother Aaron was gathered,
- 14 *For ye rebelled against my commandment in the desert of Zin, in the strife of the congregation, to sanctify me at the water before their eyes: that is the water of Meribah in Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.* because you rebelled against my command in the wilderness of Zin when the congregation quarreled, failing to uphold me as holy at the waters before their eyes.' These are the waters of Meribah of Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.
- 15 *And Moses spake unto the LORD, saying,* Moses spoke to the LORD, saying,
- 16 *Let the LORD, the God of the spirits of all flesh, set a man over the congregation,* 'Let the LORD, the God of the spirits of all flesh, appoint a man over the congregation
- 17 *Which may go out before them, and which may go in before them, and which may lead them out, and which may bring them in; that the congregation of the LORD be not as sheep which have no shepherd.* who shall go out before them and come in before them, who shall lead them out and bring them in, that the congregation of the LORD may not be as sheep that have no shepherd.'

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| <p>18 <i>And the LORD said unto Moses, Take thee Joshua the son of Nun, a man in whom is the spirit, and lay thine hand upon him;</i></p> <p>19 <i>And set him before Eleazar the priest, and before all the congregation; and give him a charge in their sight.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And thou shalt put some of thine honour upon him, that all the congregation of the children of Israel may be obedient.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And he shall stand before Eleazar the priest, who shall ask counsel for him after the judgment of Urim before the LORD: at his word shall they go out, and at his word they shall come in, both he, and all the children of Israel with him, even all the congregation.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Moses did as the LORD commanded him: and he took Joshua, and set him before Eleazar the priest, and before all the congregation:</i></p> <p>23 <i>And he laid his hands upon him, and gave him a charge, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.</i></p> | <p>the LORD said to Moses, 'Take Joshua the son of Nun, a man in whom is the Spirit, and lay your hand on him.</p> <p>Make him stand before Eleazar the priest and all the congregation, and you shall commission him in their sight.</p> <p>You shall invest him with some of your authority, so that all the congregation of the people of Israel may obey.</p> <p>he shall stand before Eleazar the priest, who shall inquire for him by the judgment of the Urim before the LORD. At His word they shall go out, and at His word they shall come in, both He and all the people of Israel with him, the whole congregation.'</p> <p>Moses did as the LORD commanded Him. He took Joshua and made him stand before Eleazar the priest and the whole congregation,</p> <p>he laid His hands on Him and commissioned Him, as the LORD directed through Moses.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

Cross-References:

v1 — Num 26:33; Gal 3:28

v3 — Num 26:64-65

v11 — Num 35:29

v14 — Deut 1:37; Deut 32:51-52; Num 20:8-13; Ex 17:7; Ps 106:32-33

v16 — Num 16:22; Heb 12:9; Jer 3:15; Deut 31:14; John 10:11

v17 — Ezek 34:5; Mark 6:34; 1 Kgs 22:17; Matt 9:36; Deut 31:2

v18 — Deut 34:9; Gen 41:38; Num 27:23; Deut 3:28; Deut 31:7-8

v21 — Josh 9:14; 1 Sam 28:6; Ex 28:30

Chapter 28

The LORD restates the laws of the daily burnt offerings -- two lambs each morning and evening -- and the additional offerings required on the Sabbath, at the beginning of each month, and during the feasts of Passover and Unleavened Bread and the Feast of Weeks.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 <i>Command the children of Israel, and say unto them, My offering, and my bread for my sacrifices made by fire, for a sweet savour unto me, shall ye observe to offer unto me in their due season.</i> | 'Command the people of Israel and say to them, "My offering, my food for my offerings made by fire, my sweet savour, You shall be careful to offer to me at its appointed time." |
| 3 <i>And thou shalt say unto them, This is the offering made by fire which ye shall offer unto the LORD; two lambs of the first year without spot day by day, for a continual burnt offering.</i> | you shall say to them, "This is the offering made by fire that You shall offer to the LORD: two male lambs a year old without blemish, day by day, as a regular burnt offering. |
| 4 <i>The one lamb shalt thou offer in the morning, and the other lamb shalt thou offer at even;</i> | One lamb You shall offer in the morning, and the other lamb You shall offer at twilight; |
| 5 <i>And a tenth part of an ephah of flour for a meat offering, mingled with the fourth part of an hin of beaten oil.</i> | also a tenth of an ephah of fine flour for a grain offering, mixed with a quarter of a hin of beaten oil. |
| 6 <i>It is a continual burnt offering, which was ordained in mount Sinai for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.</i> | It is a regular burnt offering, which was ordained at Mount Sinai for a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD. |

- 7 *And the drink offering thereof shall be the fourth part of an hin for the one lamb: in the holy place shalt thou cause the strong wine to be poured unto the LORD for a drink offering.* Its drink offering shall be a quarter of a hin for each lamb. In the sanctuary You shall pour out a drink offering of strong drink to the LORD.
- 8 *And the other lamb shalt thou offer at even: as the meat offering of the morning, and as the drink offering thereof, thou shalt offer it, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.* The other lamb You shall offer at twilight. Like the grain offering of the morning and like its drink offering, You shall offer it as a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD.
- 9 *And on the sabbath day two lambs of the first year without spot, and two tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, and the drink offering thereof:* On the Sabbath day, two male lambs a year old without blemish, and two tenths of an ephah of fine flour for a grain offering, mixed with oil, and its drink offering:
- 10 *This is the burnt offering of every sabbath, beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.* this is the burnt offering of every Sabbath, besides the regular burnt offering and its drink offering.
- 11 *And in the beginnings of your months ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, seven lambs of the first year without spot;* At the beginnings of Your months, You shall offer a burnt offering to the LORD: two bulls from the herd, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old without blemish;
- 12 *And three tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, for one bullock; and two tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, for one ram;* also three tenths of an ephah of fine flour for a grain offering, mixed with oil, for each bull, and two tenths of fine flour for a grain offering, mixed with oil, for the one ram,
- 13 *And a several tenth deal of flour mingled with oil for a meat offering unto one lamb; for a burnt offering of a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.* a tenth of fine flour mixed with oil as a grain offering for every lamb; for a burnt offering of sweet savour, a offering made by fire to the LORD.

- 14 *And their drink offerings shall be half an hin of wine unto a bullock, and the third part of an hin unto a ram, and a fourth part of an hin unto a lamb: this is the burnt offering of every month throughout the months of the year.* Their drink offerings shall be half a hin of wine for a bull, a third of a hin for a ram, and a quarter of a hin for a lamb. This is the burnt offering of each month throughout the months of the year.
- 15 *And one kid of the goats for a sin offering unto the LORD shall be offered, beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.* Also one male goat for a sin offering to the LORD; it shall be offered besides the regular burnt offering and its drink offering.
- 16 *And in the fourteenth day of the first month is the passover of the LORD.* On the fourteenth day of the first month is the LORD's Passover.
- 17 *And in the fifteenth day of this month is the feast: seven days shall unleavened bread be eaten.* on the fifteenth day of this month is a feast. Seven days shall unleavened bread be eaten.
- 18 *In the first day shall be an holy convocation; ye shall do no manner of servile work therein:* On the first day there shall be a holy assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work,
- 19 *But ye shall offer a sacrifice made by fire for a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, and seven lambs of the first year: they shall be unto you without blemish:* but offer a offering made by fire, a burnt offering to the LORD: two bulls from the herd, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old; see that they are without blemish.
- 20 *And their meat offering shall be of flour mingled with oil: three tenth deals shall ye offer for a bullock, and two tenth deals for a ram;* their grain offering shall be of fine flour mixed with oil; three tenths of an ephah shall You offer for a bull, and two tenths for a ram;
- 21 *A several tenth deal shalt thou offer for every lamb, throughout the seven lambs:* a tenth shall You offer for each of the seven lambs;
- 22 *And one goat for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you.* also one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for You.

- 23 *Ye shall offer these beside the burnt offering in the morning, which is for a continual burnt offering.* You shall offer these besides the burnt offering of the morning, which is for a regular burnt offering.
- 24 *After this manner ye shall offer daily, throughout the seven days, the meat of the sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: it shall be offered beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.* In the same way You shall offer daily, for seven days, the food of a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD. It shall be offered besides the regular burnt offering and its drink offering.
- 25 *And on the seventh day ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work.* on the seventh day You shall have a holy assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 26 *Also in the day of the firstfruits, when ye bring a new meat offering unto the LORD, after your weeks be out, ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work:* On the day of the firstfruits, when You offer a grain offering of new grain to the LORD at Your Feast of Weeks, You shall have a holy assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 27 *But ye shall offer the burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD; two young bullocks, one ram, seven lambs of the first year;* you shall offer a burnt offering, a sweet savour unto the LORD: two bulls from the herd, one ram, seven male lambs a year old;
- 28 *And their meat offering of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals unto one bullock, two tenth deals unto one ram,* also their grain offering of fine flour mixed with oil — three tenths of an ephah for each bull, two tenths for the one ram,
- 29 *A several tenth deal unto one lamb, throughout the seven lambs;* a tenth for each of the seven lambs;
- 30 *And one kid of the goats, to make an atonement for you.* with one male goat, to make atonement for You.
- 31 *Ye shall offer them beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, (they shall be unto you without blemish) and their drink offerings.* Besides the regular burnt offering and its grain offering, You shall offer them and their drink offerings. See that they are without blemish.

Words in this chapter:

- firstfruits** — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.
- passover** — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.
- sabbath** (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.
- Sinai** (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Lev 3:11
- v5** — Lev 2:1
- v11** — Num 10:10
- v17** — Lev 23:6
- v25** — Lev 23:8
- v26** — Ex 34:22; Ex 23:16

Chapter 29

The LORD prescribes the offerings for the Feast of Trumpets on the first day of the seventh month, the Day of Atonement on the tenth, and the Feast of Tabernacles from the fifteenth through the twenty-second. The Feast of Tabernacles requires a decreasing number of bulls over its seven days, totaling seventy bulls.

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| 1 | <i>And in the seventh month, on the first day of the month, ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work: it is a day of blowing the trumpets unto you.</i> | On the first day of the seventh month You shall have a holy assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work. It is a day for You to blow the trumpets. |
| 2 | <i>And ye shall offer a burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year without blemish:</i> | you shall offer a burnt offering, a sweet savour unto the LORD: one bull from the herd, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without blemish; |
| 3 | <i>And their meat offering shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals for a bullock, and two tenth deals for a ram,</i> | also their grain offering of fine flour mixed with oil — three tenths of an ephah for the bull, two tenths for the ram, |

- 4 *And one tenth deal for one lamb, throughout the seven lambs:* one tenth for each of the seven lambs;
- 5 *And one kid of the goats for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you:* with one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for You;
- 6 *Beside the burnt offering of the month, and his meat offering, and the daily burnt offering, and his meat offering, and their drink offerings, according unto their manner, for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.* besides the burnt offering of the new moon and its grain offering and the regular burnt offering and its grain offering. Their drink offerings, according to the rule for them, as a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.
- 7 *And ye shall have on the tenth day of this seventh month an holy convocation; and ye shall afflict your souls: ye shall not do any work therein:* On the tenth day of this seventh month You shall have a holy assembly and afflict yourselves. You shall do no work,
- 8 *But ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD for a sweet savour; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year; they shall be unto you without blemish:* but You shall offer a burnt offering to the LORD, a sweet savour: one bull from the herd, one ram, seven male lambs a year old; they shall be without blemish.
- 9 *And their meat offering shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals to a bullock, and two tenth deals to one ram,* their grain offering shall be of fine flour mixed with oil — three tenths of an ephah for the bull, two tenths for the one ram,
- 10 *A several tenth deal for one lamb, throughout the seven lambs:* a tenth for each of the seven lambs:
- 11 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the sin offering of atonement, and the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering of it, and their drink offerings.* one male goat for a sin offering, besides the sin offering of atonement and the regular burnt offering and its grain offering and their drink offerings.

- 12 *And on the fifteenth day of the seventh month ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work, and ye shall keep a feast unto the LORD seven days:* On the fifteenth day of the seventh month You shall have a holy assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work, and You shall keep a feast to the LORD seven days.
- 13 *And ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD; thirteen young bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year; they shall be without blemish:* you shall offer a burnt offering, a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD, thirteen bulls from the herd, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old; they shall be without blemish;
- 14 *And their meat offering shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals unto every bullock of the thirteen bullocks, two tenth deals to each ram of the two rams,* their grain offering of fine flour mixed with oil — three tenths of an ephah for each of the thirteen bulls, two tenths for each of the two rams,
- 15 *And a several tenth deal to each lamb of the fourteen lambs:* a tenth for each of the fourteen lambs;
- 16 *And one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering, its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 17 *And on the second day ye shall offer twelve young bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without spot:* On the second day twelve bulls from the herd, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 18 *And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 19 *And one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering thereof, and their drink offerings.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering and its grain offering and their drink offerings.

- 20 *And on the third day eleven bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish;* On the third day eleven bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 21 *And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 22 *And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering and its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 23 *And on the fourth day ten bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:* On the fourth day ten bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 24 *Their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 25 *And one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering, its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 26 *And on the fifth day nine bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without spot:* On the fifth day nine bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 27 *And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 28 *And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering and its grain offering and its drink offering.

- 29 *And on the sixth day eight bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:* On the sixth day eight bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 30 *And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 31 *And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering, its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 32 *And on the seventh day seven bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:* On the seventh day seven bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without blemish,
- 33 *And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:* with their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, the rams, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
- 34 *And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.* also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering, its grain offering and its drink offering.
- 35 *On the eighth day ye shall have a solemn assembly: ye shall do no servile work therein:* On the eighth day You shall have a solemn assembly. You shall not do any ordinary work.
- 36 *But ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: one bullock, one ram, seven lambs of the first year without blemish:* But You shall offer a burnt offering, a offering made by fire, a sweet savour unto the LORD: one bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without blemish,

37	<i>Their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullock, for the ram, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:</i>	their grain offering and their drink offerings for the bull, the ram, and the lambs, by number according to the rule;
38	<i>And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.</i>	also one male goat for a sin offering, besides the regular burnt offering and its grain offering and its drink offering.
39	<i>These things ye shall do unto the LORD in your set feasts, beside your vows, and your freewill offerings, for your burnt offerings, and for your meat offerings, and for your drink offerings, and for your peace offerings.</i>	These You shall offer to the LORD at Your appointed feasts, in addition to Your vow offerings and Your freewill offerings, for Your burnt offerings, and for Your grain offerings, and for Your drink offerings, and for Your peace offerings.
40	<i>And Moses told the children of Israel according to all that the LORD commanded Moses.</i>	Moses told the people of Israel everything just as the LORD had commanded Moses.

Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 23:24-25
- v7 — Lev 16:29-31; Matt 5:4
- v11 — Lev 16:3
- v35 — Lev 23:36
- v39 — Lev 23:2; 2 Chr 31:3

Chapter 30

Moses gives the law of vows. A man's vow to the LORD is binding in every case, but a woman's vow may be voided by her father if she is in his house, or by her husband on the day he hears of it; if neither objects, her vow stands.

- 1 *And Moses spake unto the heads of the tribes concerning the children of Israel, saying, This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded.* Moses spoke to the heads of the tribes of the people of Israel, saying, 'This is what the LORD has commanded.
- 2 *If a man vow a vow unto the LORD, or swear an oath to bind his soul with a bond; he shall not break his word, he shall do according to all that proceedeth out of his mouth.* If a man vows a vow to the LORD, or swears an oath to bind Himself by a pledge, He shall not break His word. He shall do according to all that proceeds out of His mouth.
- 3 *If a woman also vow a vow unto the LORD, and bind herself by a bond, being in her father's house in her youth;* If a woman vows a vow to the LORD and binds herself by a pledge, while within her father's house in her youth,
- 4 *And her father hear her vow, and her bond wherewith she hath bound her soul, and her father shall hold his peace at her; then all her vows shall stand, and every bond wherewith she hath bound her soul shall stand.* her father hears of her vow and of her pledge by which she has bound herself and says nothing to her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge by which she has bound herself shall stand.
- 5 *But if her father disallow her in the day that he heareth; not any of her vows, or of her bonds wherewith she hath bound her soul, shall stand: and the LORD shall forgive her, because her father disallowed her.* But if her father opposes her on the day that He hears of it, none of her vows or her pledges by which she has bound herself shall stand. And the LORD will forgive her, because her father had opposed her.
- 6 *And if she had at all an husband, when she vowed, or uttered ought out of her lips, wherewith she bound her soul;* If she marries a husband, while under her vows or any thoughtless pledge by which she has bound herself,
- 7 *And her husband heard it, and held his peace at her in the day that he heard it: then her vows shall stand, and her bonds wherewith she bound her soul shall stand.* her husband hears of it and says nothing to her on the day that He hears, then her vows shall stand. Her pledges by which she bound herself shall stand.

- 8 *But if her husband disallowed her on the day that he heard it; then he shall make her vow which she vowed, and that which she uttered with her lips, wherewith she bound her soul, of none effect: and the LORD shall forgive her.* But if, on the day that her husband comes to hear of it, He opposes her, then He makes void her vow that was on her, and the thoughtless pledge she uttered. And the LORD will forgive her.
- 9 *But every vow of a widow, and of her that is divorced, wherewith they have bound their souls, shall stand against her.* But any vow of a widow or of a divorced woman, anything by which she has bound herself, shall stand against her.
- 10 *And if she vowed in her husband's house, or bound her soul by a bond with an oath;* if she vowed in her husband's house or bound herself by a pledge with an oath
- 11 *And her husband heard it, and held his peace at her, and disallowed her not: then all her vows shall stand, and every bond wherewith she bound her soul shall stand.* her husband heard of it and said nothing to her and did not oppose her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge by which she bound herself shall stand.
- 12 *But if her husband hath utterly made them void on the day he heard them; then whatsoever proceeded out of her lips concerning her vows, or concerning the bond of her soul, shall not stand: her husband hath made them void; and the LORD shall forgive her.* But if her husband makes them null and void on the day that He hears them, then whatever proceeds out of her lips concerning her vows or concerning her pledge of herself shall not stand. Her husband has made them void. The LORD will forgive her.
- 13 *Every vow, and every binding oath to afflict the soul, her husband may establish it, or her husband may make it void.* Any vow and any binding oath to afflict herself, her husband may establish, or her husband may make void.

14	<i>But if her husband altogether hold his peace at her from day to day; then he establisheth all her vows, or all her bonds, which are upon her: he confirmeth them, because he held his peace at her in the day that he heard them.</i>	But if her husband says nothing to her from day to day, then He establishes all her vows or all her pledges that are upon her. He has established them, because He said nothing to her on the day that He heard of them.
15	<i>But if he shall any ways make them void after that he hath heard them; then he shall bear her iniquity.</i>	But if He makes them void after He has heard of them, then He shall bear her iniquity.'
16	<i>These are the statutes, which the LORD commanded Moses, between a man and his wife, between the father and his daughter, being yet in her youth in her father's house.</i>	These are the statutes that the LORD commanded Moses about a man and his wife and about a father and his daughter while she is in her youth within her father's house.

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 50:14; Ps 116:14; Eccl 5:4-5; Job 22:27; Ps 66:13-14

Chapter 31

The LORD commands Moses to execute vengeance on the Midianites for leading Israel into sin at Peor. Twelve thousand Israelite soldiers defeat Midian, killing all the males including the five kings of Midian and Balaam the son of Beor; the plunder is divided between the warriors and the congregation.

1	<i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i>	The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
2	<i>Avenge the children of Israel of the Midianites: afterward shalt thou be gathered unto thy people.</i>	'Avenge the people of Israel on the Midianites. Afterward you shall be gathered to Your people.'

- 3 *And Moses spake unto the people, saying, Arm some of yourselves unto the war, and let them go against the Midianites, and avenge the LORD of Midian.* So Moses spoke to the people, saying, 'Arm men from among you for the war, that they may go against Midian to execute the LORD's vengeance on Midian.
- 4 *Of every tribe a thousand, throughout all the tribes of Israel, shall ye send to the war.* You shall send a thousand from each of the tribes of Israel to the war.'
- 5 *So there were delivered out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand of every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war.* So there were furnished, out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand from each tribe — 12,000 armed for war.
- 6 *And Moses sent them to the war, a thousand of every tribe, them and Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the holy instruments, and the trumpets to blow in his hand.* Moses sent them to the war, a thousand from each tribe, together with Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, with the vessels of the sanctuary and the trumpets for the alarm in his hand.
- 7 *And they warred against the Midianites, as the LORD commanded Moses; and they slew all the males.* They warred against Midian, as the LORD commanded Moses, and killed every male.
- 8 *And they slew the kings of Midian, beside the rest of them that were slain; namely, Evi, and Rekem, and Zur, and Hur, and Reba, five kings of Midian: Balaam also the son of Beor they slew with the sword.* They killed the kings of Midian with the rest of their slain: Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the five kings of Midian. And they also killed Balaam the son of Beor with the sword.
- 9 *And the children of Israel took all the women of Midian captives, and their little ones, and took the spoil of all their cattle, and all their flocks, and all their goods.* the people of Israel took captive the women of Midian and their little ones. They took as plunder all their cattle, all their flocks. All their goods.
- 10 *And they burnt all their cities wherein they dwelt, and all their goodly castles, with fire.* All their cities in the places where they lived. All their encampments, they burned with fire.

- 11 *And they took all the spoil, and all the prey, both of men and of beasts.* they took all the plunder and all the spoil, both of people and of animals.
- 12 *And they brought the captives, and the prey, and the spoil, unto Moses, and Eleazar the priest, and unto the congregation of the children of Israel, unto the camp at the plains of Moab, which are by Jordan near Jericho.* Then they brought the captives and the plunder and the spoil to Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of the people of Israel, at the camp on the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.
- 13 *And Moses, and Eleazar the priest, and all the princes of the congregation, went forth to meet them without the camp.* Moses and Eleazar the priest and all the chiefs of the congregation went to meet them outside the camp.
- 14 *And Moses was wroth with the officers of the host, with the captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, which came from the battle.* Moses was angry with the officers of the army, the commanders of thousands and the commanders of hundreds, who had come from service in the battle.
- 15 *And Moses said unto them, Have ye saved all the women alive?* Moses said to them, 'Have you let all the women live?
- 16 *Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and there was a plague among the congregation of the LORD.* these, on Balaam's advice, caused the people of Israel to act treacherously against the LORD in the incident of Peor, and so the plague came among the congregation of the LORD.
- 17 *Now therefore kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman that hath known man by lying with him.* Now therefore, kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman who has known man by lying with Him.
- 18 *But all the women children, that have not known a man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves.* But all the young girls who have not known man by lying with Him, keep alive for yourselves.

- 19 *And do ye abide without the camp seven days: whosoever hath killed any person, and whosoever hath touched any slain, purify both yourselves and your captives on the third day, and on the seventh day.* Encamp outside the camp seven days. Whoever has killed any person and whoever has touched any slain, purify yourselves and Your captives on the third day and on the seventh day.
- 20 *And purify all your raiment, and all that is made of skins, and all work of goats' hair, and all things made of wood.* You shall also purify every garment, every article of skin, all work of goats' hair, and every article of wood.'
- 21 *And Eleazar the priest said unto the men of war which went to the battle, This is the ordinance of the law which the LORD commanded Moses;* Eleazar the priest said to the men of war who had gone to battle: 'This is the statute of the law that the LORD has commanded Moses:
- 22 *Only the gold, and the silver, the brass, the iron, the tin, and the lead,* only the gold, the silver, the bronze, the iron, the tin, and the lead,
- 23 *Every thing that may abide the fire, ye shall make it go through the fire, and it shall be clean: nevertheless it shall be purified with the water of separation: and all that abideth not the fire ye shall make go through the water.* everything that can stand fire, You shall pass through fire. It shall be clean. Nevertheless, it shall also be purified with the water for impurity. And whatever cannot stand fire, You shall pass through water.
- 24 *And ye shall wash your clothes on the seventh day, and ye shall be clean, and afterward ye shall come into the camp.* You shall wash Your clothes on the seventh day, and You shall be clean. And afterward You may come into the camp.'
- 25 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 26 *Take the sum of the prey that was taken, both of man and of beast, thou, and Eleazar the priest, and the chief fathers of the congregation:* 'Take the count of the plunder that was taken, both of people and of animals, you and Eleazar the priest and the heads of the fathers' houses of the congregation.

- 27 *And divide the prey into two parts; between them that took the war upon them, who went out to battle, and between all the congregation:* divide the plunder into two parts between the warriors who went out to battle and all the congregation.
- 28 *And levy a tribute unto the LORD of the men of war which went out to battle: one soul of five hundred, both of the persons, and of the beeves, and of the asses, and of the sheep:* levy for the LORD a tribute from the men of war who went out to battle, one out of five hundred, of the people and of the oxen and of the donkeys and of the flocks.
- 29 *Take it of their half, and give it unto Eleazar the priest, for an heave offering of the LORD.* Take it from their half and give it to Eleazar the priest as a contribution to the LORD.
- 30 *And of the children of Israel's half, thou shalt take one portion of fifty, of the persons, of the beeves, of the asses, and of the flocks, of all manner of beasts, and give them unto the Levites, which keep the charge of the tabernacle of the LORD.* from the people of Israel's half you shall take one out of every fifty, of the people, of the oxen, of the donkeys, and of the flocks, of every kind of animal, and give them to the Levites who keep guard over the tabernacle of the LORD.'
- 31 *And Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD commanded Moses.* Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 32 *And the booty, being the rest of the prey which the men of war had caught, was six hundred thousand and seventy thousand and five thousand sheep,* Now the plunder remaining of the spoil that the men of war had taken was 675,000 sheep,
- 33 *And threescore and twelve thousand beeves,* 72,000 cattle,
- 34 *And threescore and one thousand asses,* 61,000 donkeys,
- 35 *And thirty and two thousand persons in all, of women that had not known man by lying with him.* 32,000 persons in all, women who had not known man by lying with Him.

- 36 *And the half, which was the portion of them that went out to war, was in number three hundred thousand and seven and thirty thousand and five hundred sheep:* the half, the portion of those who had gone out to war, was in number 337,500 sheep,
- 37 *And the LORD's tribute of the sheep was six hundred and threescore and fifteen.* the LORD's tribute of sheep was 675.
- 38 *And the beeves were thirty and six thousand; of which the LORD's tribute was threescore and twelve.* The cattle were 36,000, of which the LORD's tribute was 72.
- 39 *And the asses were thirty thousand and five hundred; of which the LORD's tribute was threescore and one.* The donkeys were 30,500, of which the LORD's tribute was 61.
- 40 *And the persons were sixteen thousand; of which the LORD's tribute was thirty and two persons.* The persons were 16,000, of which the LORD's tribute was 32 persons.
- 41 *And Moses gave the tribute, which was the LORD's heave offering, unto Eleazar the priest, as the LORD commanded Moses.* Moses gave the tribute, which was the LORD's contribution, to Eleazar the priest, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 42 *And of the children of Israel's half, which Moses divided from the men that warred,* from the people of Israel's half, which Moses separated from that of the men who had gone to war —
- 43 *(Now the half that pertained unto the congregation was three hundred thousand and thirty thousand and seven thousand and five hundred sheep,* now the congregation's half was 337,500 sheep,
- 44 *And thirty and six thousand beeves,* 36,000 cattle,
- 45 *And thirty thousand asses and five hundred,* 30,500 donkeys,
- 46 *And sixteen thousand persons;)* 16,000 persons —

- 47 *Even of the children of Israel's half, Moses took one portion of fifty, both of man and of beast, and gave them unto the Levites, which kept the charge of the tabernacle of the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.* from the people of Israel's half Moses took one of every fifty, both of people and of animals, and gave them to the Levites who kept guard over the tabernacle of the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 48 *And the officers which were over thousands of the host, the captains of thousands, and captains of hundreds, came near unto Moses:* Then the officers who were over the thousands of the army, the commanders of thousands and the commanders of hundreds, came near to Moses
- 49 *And they said unto Moses, Thy servants have taken the sum of the men of war which are under our charge, and there lacketh not one man of us.* said to Moses, 'Your servants have counted the men of war who are under our command, and there is not a man missing from us.
- 50 *We have therefore brought an oblation for the LORD, what every man hath gotten, of jewels of gold, chains, and bracelets, rings, earrings, and tablets, to make an atonement for our souls before the LORD.* we have brought the LORD's offering, what each man found, articles of gold, armlets and bracelets, signet rings, earrings, and beads, to make atonement for ourselves before the LORD.'
- 51 *And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of them, even all wrought jewels.* Moses and Eleazar the priest received from them the gold, all of it in worked articles.
- 52 *And all the gold of the offering that they offered up to the LORD, of the captains of thousands, and of the captains of hundreds, was sixteen thousand seven hundred and fifty shekels.* all the gold of the contribution that they contributed to the LORD, from the commanders of thousands and the commanders of hundreds, was 16,750 shekels.
- 53 *(For the men of war had taken spoil, every man for himself.)* The men of war had each taken plunder for Himself.

- 54 *And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and brought it into the tabernacle of the congregation, for a memorial for the children of Israel before the LORD.* Moses and Eleazar the priest received the gold from the commanders of thousands and of hundreds and brought it into the tent of meeting as a memorial for the people of Israel before the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v7 — Judg 21:11; 1 Kgs 11:15-16
 v8 — Josh 13:21-22; Num 25:15
 v11 — Deut 20:14
 v16 — Num 25:1-9; 2 Pet 2:15; Rev 2:14; Deut 4:3; Josh 22:17
 v23 — Num 19:9
 v27 — Josh 22:8
 v49 — John 18:9; 1 Sam 30:18-19; Ps 72:14
 v53 — Deut 20:14

Chapter 32

The tribes of Reuben and Gad, who have large herds, ask Moses for the land east of the Jordan as their inheritance. Moses rebukes them but agrees on the condition that their armed men cross the Jordan and fight alongside the other tribes until Canaan is conquered; the half-tribe of Manasseh also settles east of the Jordan.

- 1 *Now the children of Reuben and the children of Gad had a very great multitude of cattle: and when they saw the land of Jazer, and the land of Gilead, that, behold, the place was a place for cattle;* Now the people of Reuben and the people of Gad had a very great number of livestock. And they saw the land of Jazer and the land of Gilead, and the place was a place for livestock.
- 2 *The children of Gad and the children of Reuben came and spake unto Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and unto the princes of the congregation, saying,* the people of Gad and the people of Reuben came and said to Moses and to Eleazar the priest and to the chiefs of the congregation,

- 3 *Ataroth, and Dibon, and Jazer, and Nimrah, and Heshbon, and Elealeh, and Shebam, and Nebo, and Beon,* 'Ataroth, Dibon, Jazer, Nimrah, Heshbon, Elealeh, Sebam, Nebo, and Beon,
- 4 *Even the country which the LORD smote before the congregation of Israel, is a land for cattle, and thy servants have cattle:* the land that the LORD struck down before the congregation of Israel, is a land for livestock, and Your servants have livestock.'
- 5 *Wherefore, said they, if we have found grace in thy sight, let this land be given unto thy servants for a possession, and bring us not over Jordan.* they said, 'If we have found favor in Your sight, let this land be given to Your servants for a possession. Do not take us across the Jordan.'
- 6 *And Moses said unto the children of Gad and to the children of Reuben, Shall your brethren go to war, and shall ye sit here?* But Moses said to the people of Gad and to the people of Reuben, 'Shall your brothers go to the war while you sit here?
- 7 *And wherefore discourage ye the heart of the children of Israel from going over into the land which the LORD hath given them?* Why will You discourage the heart of the people of Israel from going over into the land that the LORD has given them?
- 8 *Thus did your fathers, when I sent them from Kadeshbarnea to see the land.* Your fathers did this, when I sent them from Kadesh-barnea to see the land.
- 9 *For when they went up unto the valley of Eshcol, and saw the land, they discouraged the heart of the children of Israel, that they should not go into the land which the LORD had given them.* For when they went up to the Valley of Eshcol and saw the land, they discouraged the heart of the people of Israel from going into the land that the LORD had given them.
- 10 *And the LORD's anger was kindled the same time, and he sware, saying,* the LORD's anger was kindled on that day. He swore, saying,

- 11 *Surely none of the men that came up out of Egypt, from twenty years old and upward, shall see the land which I sware unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob; because they have not wholly followed me:* "None of the men who came up out of Egypt, from twenty years old and upward, shall see the land that I swore to give to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, because they have not wholly followed me —
- 12 *Save Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite, and Joshua the son of Nun: for they have wholly followed the LORD.* none except Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite and Joshua the son of Nun, for they have wholly followed the LORD."
- 13 *And the LORD's anger was kindled against Israel, and he made them wander in the wilderness forty years, until all the generation, that had done evil in the sight of the LORD, was consumed.* the LORD's anger was kindled against Israel. He made them wander in the wilderness forty years, until all the generation that had done evil in the sight of the LORD was gone.
- 14 *And, behold, ye are risen up in your fathers' stead, an increase of sinful men, to augment yet the fierce anger of the LORD toward Israel.* you have risen in Your fathers' place, a brood of sinful men, to increase still more the fierce anger of the LORD against Israel!
- 15 *For if ye turn away from after him, he will yet again leave them in the wilderness; and ye shall destroy all this people.* For if You turn away from following Him, He will again abandon them in the wilderness, and You will destroy all this people.'
- 16 *And they came near unto him, and said, We will build sheepfolds here for our cattle, and cities for our little ones:* Then they came near to Him and said, 'We will build sheepfolds here for our livestock, and cities for our little ones,
- 17 *But we ourselves will go ready armed before the children of Israel, until we have brought them unto their place: and our little ones shall dwell in the fenced cities because of the inhabitants of the land.* but we will take up arms, ready to go before the people of Israel, until we have brought them to their place. And our little ones shall live in the fortified cities because of the inhabitants of the land.

- 18 *We will not return unto our houses, until the children of Israel have inherited every man his inheritance.* We will not return to our homes until each of the people of Israel has gained his inheritance.
- 19 *For we will not inherit with them on yonder side Jordan, or forward; because our inheritance is fallen to us on this side Jordan eastward.* For we will not inherit with them on the other side of the Jordan and beyond, because our inheritance has come to us on this side of the Jordan to the east.'
- 20 *And Moses said unto them, If ye will do this thing, if ye will go armed before the LORD to war,* Moses said to them, 'If you will do this, if you will take up arms to go before the LORD for the war,
- 21 *And will go all of you armed over Jordan before the LORD, until he hath driven out his enemies from before him,* every armed man of You will pass over the Jordan before the LORD, until He has driven out His enemies from before Him
- 22 *And the land be subdued before the LORD: then afterward ye shall return, and be guiltless before the LORD, and before Israel; and this land shall be your possession before the LORD.* the land is subdued before the LORD; then after that You shall return and be free of obligation to the LORD and to Israel, and this land shall be Your possession before the LORD.
- 23 *But if ye will not do so, behold, ye have sinned against the LORD: and be sure your sin will find you out.* But if You will not do so, You have sinned against the LORD, and be sure Your sin will find You out.
- 24 *Build you cities for your little ones, and folds for your sheep; and do that which hath proceeded out of your mouth.* Build cities for Your little ones and folds for Your sheep, and do what You have promised.'
- 25 *And the children of Gad and the children of Reuben spake unto Moses, saying, Thy servants will do as my lord commandeth.* the people of Gad and the people of Reuben said to Moses, 'Your servants will do as my lord commands.
- 26 *Our little ones, our wives, our flocks, and all our cattle, shall be there in the cities of Gilead:* Our little ones, our wives, our flocks. All our livestock shall be there in the cities of Gilead,

- 27 *But thy servants will pass over, every man armed for war, before the LORD to battle, as my lord saith.* but Your servants will pass over, every man who is armed for war, before the LORD to battle, as my lord orders.'
- 28 *So concerning them Moses commanded Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun, and the chief fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel:* So Moses gave command concerning them to Eleazar the priest and to Joshua the son of Nun and to the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the people of Israel.
- 29 *And Moses said unto them, If the children of Gad and the children of Reuben will pass with you over Jordan, every man armed to battle, before the LORD, and the land shall be subdued before you; then ye shall give them the land of Gilead for a possession:* Moses said to them, 'If the people of Gad and the people of Reuben, every man who is armed to battle before the LORD, will pass with You over the Jordan and the land shall be subdued before You, then You shall give them the land of Gilead for a possession.
- 30 *But if they will not pass over with you armed, they shall have possessions among you in the land of Canaan.* But if they will not pass over with You armed, they shall have possessions among You in the land of Canaan.'
- 31 *And the children of Gad and the children of Reuben answered, saying, As the LORD hath said unto thy servants, so will we do.* the people of Gad and the people of Reuben answered, 'What the LORD has said to Your servants, we will do.
- 32 *We will pass over armed before the LORD into the land of Canaan, that the possession of our inheritance on this side Jordan may be ours.* We will pass over armed before the LORD into the land of Canaan, and the possession of our inheritance shall remain with us beyond the Jordan.'

- 33 *And Moses gave unto them, even to the children of Gad, and to the children of Reuben, and unto half the tribe of Manasseh the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, the land, with the cities thereof in the coasts, even the cities of the country round about.* Moses gave to them — to the people of Gad and to the people of Reuben and to the half-tribe of Manasseh the son of Joseph — the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, the land and its cities with their territories, the cities of the surrounding land.
- 34 *And the children of Gad built Dibon, and Ataroth, and Aroer,* the people of Gad built Dibon, Ataroth, Aroer,
- 35 *And Atroth, Shophan, and Jaazer, and Jogbehah,* Atroth-shophan, Jazer, Jogbehah,
- 36 *And Bethnimrah, and Bethharan, fenced cities: and folds for sheep.* Beth-nimrah and Beth-haran — fortified cities — and folds for sheep.
- 37 *And the children of Reuben built Heshbon, and Elealeh, and Kirjathaim,* the people of Reuben built Heshbon, Elealeh, Kiriathaim,
- 38 *And Nebo, and Baalmeon, (their names being changed,) and Shibmah: and gave other names unto the cities which they builded.* Nebo, and Baal-meon (their names were changed) and Sibmah. And they gave other names to the cities that they built.
- 39 *And the children of Machir the son of Manasseh went to Gilead, and took it, and dispossessed the Amorite which was in it.* the sons of Machir the son of Manasseh went to Gilead and captured it, and dispossessed the Amorites who were in it.
- 40 *And Moses gave Gilead unto Machir the son of Manasseh; and he dwelt therein.* Moses gave Gilead to Machir the son of Manasseh. He settled in it.
- 41 *And Jair the son of Manasseh went and took the small towns thereof, and called them Havothjair.* Jair the son of Manasseh went and captured their villages and called them Havvoth-jair.

- 42

And Nobah went and took Kenath, and the villages thereof, and called it Nobah, after his own name.
- Nobah went and captured Kenath and its villages, and called it Nobah, after his own name.

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 21:32
- v4 — Num 21:34
- v11 — Num 14:28-30
- v12 — Deut 1:36
- v13 — 1 Cor 10:5; Heb 3:16-19; Num 14:33-35
- v17 — Josh 4:12-13
- v22 — Josh 22:4; Josh 22:9
- v23 — Isa 59:12; Prov 13:21; Gen 44:16; Ps 90:8; 1 Cor 4:5
- v33 — Josh 12:6
- v34 — Deut 2:36
- v38 — Isa 46:1
- v39 — Gen 50:23

Chapter 33

Moses records the stages of Israel's journey from Rameses in Egypt to the plains of Moab, listing over forty encampments along the way. The LORD commands Israel to drive out all the inhabitants of Canaan and destroy their idols when they cross the Jordan.

- 1

These are the journeys of the children of Israel, which went forth out of the land of Egypt with their armies under the hand of Moses and Aaron.
- These are the stages of the people of Israel, when they went out of the land of Egypt by their companies under the leadership of Moses and Aaron.
- 2

And Moses wrote their goings out according to their journeys by the commandment of the LORD: and these are their journeys according to their goings out.
- Moses wrote down their starting places, stage by stage, by command of the LORD, and these are their stages according to their starting places.

- 3 *And they departed from Rameses in the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month; on the morrow after the passover the children of Israel went out with an high hand in the sight of all the Egyptians.* They set out from Rameses in the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month. On the day after the Passover, the people of Israel went out triumphantly in the sight of all the Egyptians,
- 4 *For the Egyptians buried all their firstborn, which the LORD had smitten among them: upon their gods also the LORD executed judgments.* while the Egyptians were burying all their firstborn, whom the LORD had struck down among them. On their gods also the LORD executed judgments.
- 5 *And the children of Israel removed from Rameses, and pitched in Succoth.* So the people of Israel set out from Rameses and camped at Succoth.
- 6 *And they departed from Succoth, and pitched in Etham, which is in the edge of the wilderness.* they set out from Succoth and camped at Etham, which is on the edge of the wilderness.
- 7 *And they removed from Etham, and turned again unto Pihahiroth, which is before Baalzephon: and they pitched before Migdol.* they set out from Etham and turned back to Pi-hahiroth, which is to the east of Baal-zephon. They camped before Migdol.
- 8 *And they departed from before Pihahiroth, and passed through the midst of the sea into the wilderness, and went three days' journey in the wilderness of Etham, and pitched in Marah.* they set out from before Pihahiroth and passed through the midst of the sea into the wilderness. They went a three days' journey in the wilderness of Etham and camped at Marah.
- 9 *And they removed from Marah, and came unto Elim: and in Elim were twelve fountains of water, and threescore and ten palm trees; and they pitched there.* they set out from Marah and came to Elim; at Elim there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees. They camped there.
- 10 *And they removed from Elim, and encamped by the Red sea.* they set out from Elim and camped by the Red Sea.

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| 11 | <i>And they removed from the Red sea, and encamped in the wilderness of Sin.</i> | they set out from the Red Sea and camped in the wilderness of Sin. |
| 12 | <i>And they took their journey out of the wilderness of Sin, and encamped in Dophkah.</i> | they set out from the wilderness of Sin and camped at Dophkah. |
| 13 | <i>And they departed from Dophkah, and encamped in Alush.</i> | they set out from Dophkah and camped at Alush. |
| 14 | <i>And they removed from Alush, and encamped at Rephidim, where was no water for the people to drink.</i> | they set out from Alush and camped at Rephidim, where there was no water for the people to drink. |
| 15 | <i>And they departed from Rephidim, and pitched in the wilderness of Sinai.</i> | they set out from Rephidim and camped in the wilderness of Sinai. |
| 16 | <i>And they removed from the desert of Sinai, and pitched at Kibrothhattaavah.</i> | they set out from the wilderness of Sinai and camped at Kibroth-hattaavah. |
| 17 | <i>And they departed from Kibrothhattaavah, and encamped at Hazeroth.</i> | they set out from Kibroth-hattaavah and camped at Hazeroth. |
| 18 | <i>And they departed from Hazeroth, and pitched in Rithmah.</i> | they set out from Hazeroth and camped at Rithmah. |
| 19 | <i>And they departed from Rithmah, and pitched at Rimmonparez.</i> | they set out from Rithmah and camped at Rimmon-perez. |
| 20 | <i>And they departed from Rimmonparez, and pitched in Libnah.</i> | they set out from Rimmon-perez and camped at Libnah. |
| 21 | <i>And they removed from Libnah, and pitched at Rissah.</i> | they set out from Libnah and camped at Rissah. |
| 22 | <i>And they journeyed from Rissah, and pitched in Kehelathah.</i> | they set out from Rissah and camped at Kehelathah. |
| 23 | <i>And they went from Kehelathah, and pitched in mount Shapher.</i> | they set out from Kehelathah and camped at Mount Shepher. |
| 24 | <i>And they removed from mount Shapher, and encamped in Haradah.</i> | they set out from Mount Shepher and camped at Haradah. |

- 25 *And they removed from Haradah, and pitched in Makheloth.* they set out from Haradah and camped at Makheloth.
- 26 *And they removed from Makheloth, and encamped at Tahath.* they set out from Makheloth and camped at Tahath.
- 27 *And they departed from Tahath, and pitched at Tarah.* they set out from Tahath and camped at Terah.
- 28 *And they removed from Tarah, and pitched in Mithcah.* they set out from Terah and camped at Mithkah.
- 29 *And they went from Mithcah, and pitched in Hashmonah.* they set out from Mithkah and camped at Hashmonah.
- 30 *And they departed from Hashmonah, and encamped at Moseroth.* they set out from Hashmonah and camped at Moseroth.
- 31 *And they departed from Moseroth, and pitched in Benejaakan.* they set out from Moseroth and camped at Bene-jaakan.
- 32 *And they removed from Benejaakan, and encamped at Horhagidgad.* they set out from Bene-jaakan and camped at Hor-haggidgad.
- 33 *And they went from Horhagidgad, and pitched in Jotbathah.* they set out from Hor-haggidgad and camped at Jotbathah.
- 34 *And they removed from Jotbathah, and encamped at Ebronah.* they set out from Jotbathah and camped at Abronah.
- 35 *And they departed from Ebronah, and encamped at Eziongaber.* they set out from Abronah and camped at Ezion-geber.
- 36 *And they removed from Eziongaber, and pitched in the wilderness of Zin, which is Kadesh.* they set out from Ezion-geber and camped in the wilderness of Zin, which is Kadesh.
- 37 *And they removed from Kadesh, and pitched in mount Hor, in the edge of the land of Edom.* they set out from Kadesh and camped at Mount Hor, on the edge of the land of Edom.

- 38 *And Aaron the priest went up into mount Hor at the commandment of the LORD, and died there, in the fortieth year after the children of Israel were come out of the land of Egypt, in the first day of the fifth month.* Aaron the priest went up Mount Hor at the command of the LORD and died there, in the fortieth year after the people of Israel had come out of the land of Egypt, on the first day of the fifth month.
- 39 *And Aaron was an hundred and twenty and three years old when he died in mount Hor.* Aaron was 123 years old when he died on Mount Hor.
- 40 *And king Arad the Canaanite, which dwelt in the south in the land of Canaan, heard of the coming of the children of Israel.* the Canaanite, the king of Arad, who dwelt in the south in the land of Canaan, heard of the coming of the people of Israel.
- 41 *And they departed from mount Hor, and pitched in Zalmonah.* they set out from Mount Hor and camped at Zalmonah.
- 42 *And they departed from Zalmonah, and pitched in Punon.* they set out from Zalmonah and camped at Punon.
- 43 *And they departed from Punon, and pitched in Oboth.* they set out from Punon and camped at Oboth.
- 44 *And they departed from Oboth, and pitched in Ijeabarim, in the border of Moab.* they set out from Oboth and camped at Iye-abarim, in the territory of Moab.
- 45 *And they departed from Iim, and pitched in Dibongad.* they set out from Iyim and camped at Dibon-gad.
- 46 *And they removed from Dibongad, and encamped in Almondiblathaim.* they set out from Dibon-gad and camped at Almon-diblathaim.
- 47 *And they removed from Almondiblathaim, and pitched in the mountains of Abarim, before Nebo.* they set out from Almon-diblathaim and camped in the mountains of Abarim, before Nebo.
- 48 *And they departed from the mountains of Abarim, and pitched in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.* they set out from the mountains of Abarim and camped in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.

- 49 *And they pitched by Jordan, from Bethjesimoth even unto Abelshittim in the plains of Moab.* They camped by the Jordan from Beth-jeshimoth as far as Abel-shittim in the plains of Moab.
- 50 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying,
- 51 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye are passed over Jordan into the land of Canaan;* 'Speak to the people of Israel and say to them, when you pass over the Jordan into the land of Canaan,
- 52 *Then ye shall drive out all the inhabitants of the land from before you, and destroy all their pictures, and destroy all their molten images, and quite pluck down all their high places:* then You shall drive out all the inhabitants of the land from before You and destroy all their figured stones and destroy all their metal images and demolish all their high places.
- 53 *And ye shall dispossess the inhabitants of the land, and dwell therein: for I have given you the land to possess it.* you shall take possession of the land and settle in it, for I have given the land to You to possess it.
- 54 *And ye shall divide the land by lot for an inheritance among your families: and to the more ye shall give the more inheritance, and to the fewer ye shall give the less inheritance: every man's inheritance shall be in the place where his lot falleth; according to the tribes of your fathers ye shall inherit.* You shall inherit the land by lot according to your clans. To a large clan you shall give a large inheritance, and to a small clan you shall give a small inheritance. Wherever the lot falls for anyone, that shall be his. You shall inherit according to the tribes of your fathers.
- 55 *But if ye will not drive out the inhabitants of the land from before you; then it shall come to pass, that those which ye let remain of them shall be pricks in your eyes, and thorns in your sides, and shall vex you in the land wherein ye dwell.* But if you do not drive out the inhabitants of the land from before you, then those of them whom you let remain shall be as barbs in your eyes and thorns in your sides. They shall trouble you in the land where you dwell.

56 *Moreover it shall come to pass, that I shall do unto you, as I thought to do unto them.* I will do to you as I thought to do to them.'

Words in this chapter:

Abel (AY-bel) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 77:20
- v3 — Ex 14:8
- v4 — Ex 12:12
- v5 — Ex 12:37
- v6 — Ex 13:20
- v7 — Ex 14:2
- v9 — Ex 15:27
- v38 — Deut 10:6
- v51 — Josh 3:17
- v52 — Ex 23:24; Lev 26:1; Deut 20:16-18; Deut 7:2-5; Deut 12:2-3
- v55 — Judg 2:3; Ps 106:34-36; Deut 7:16; Josh 23:12-13; Ex 23:33
- v56 — Deut 28:63

Chapter 34

The LORD defines the boundaries of the Promised Land on all four sides -- from the wilderness of Zin in the south to Mount Hor in the north, from the Great Sea in the west to the Jordan in the east. He appoints Eleazar the priest and Joshua, along with one leader from each tribe, to divide the land.

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| 1 | <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, |
| 2 | <i>Command the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye come into the land of Canaan; (this is the land that shall fall unto you for an inheritance, even the land of Canaan with the coasts thereof:)</i> | 'Command the people of Israel and say to them, when you enter the land of Canaan, this is the land that shall fall to You for an inheritance — the land of Canaan with its boundaries — |

- 3 *Then your south quarter shall be from the wilderness of Zin along by the coast of Edom, and your south border shall be the outmost coast of the salt sea eastward:* your south side shall be from the wilderness of Zin alongside Edom, and Your southern border shall run from the end of the Salt Sea on the east.
- 4 *And your border shall turn from the south to the ascent of Akrabbim, and pass on to Zin: and the going forth thereof shall be from the south to Kadeshbarnea, and shall go on to Hazaraddar, and pass on to Azmon:* your border shall turn south of the ascent of Akrabbim, and cross to Zin, and its limit shall be south of Kadesh-barnea. Then it shall go on to Hazar-addar and pass along to Azmon.
- 5 *And the border shall fetch a compass from Azmon unto the river of Egypt, and the goings out of it shall be at the sea.* the border shall turn from Azmon to the Brook of Egypt, and its limit shall be at the sea.
- 6 *And as for the western border, ye shall even have the great sea for a border: this shall be your west border.* For the western border, You shall have the Great Sea and its coast. This shall be Your western border.
- 7 *And this shall be your north border: from the great sea ye shall point out for you mount Hor:* This shall be Your northern border: from the Great Sea You shall draw a line to Mount Hor.
- 8 *From mount Hor ye shall point out your border unto the entrance of Hamath; and the goings forth of the border shall be to Zedad:* From Mount Hor You shall draw a line to the entrance of Hamath, and the limit of the border shall be at Zedad.
- 9 *And the border shall go on to Ziphron, and the goings out of it shall be at Hazarenan: this shall be your north border.* Then the border shall extend to Ziphron, and its limit shall be at Hazar-enan. This shall be Your northern border.
- 10 *And ye shall point out your east border from Hazarenan to Shepham:* You shall draw Your eastern border from Hazar-enan to Shepham.

- 11 *And the coast shall go down from Shepham to Riblah, on the east side of Ain; and the border shall descend, and shall reach unto the side of the sea of Chinnereth eastward:* the border shall go down from Shepham to Riblah on the east side of Ain. And the border shall go down and reach to the shoulder of the Sea of Chinnereth on the east.
- 12 *And the border shall go down to Jordan, and the goings out of it shall be at the salt sea: this shall be your land with the coasts thereof round about.* the border shall go down to the Jordan, and its limit shall be at the Salt Sea. This shall be Your land with its boundaries all around.'
- 13 *And Moses commanded the children of Israel, saying, This is the land which ye shall inherit by lot, which the LORD commanded to give unto the nine tribes, and to the half tribe:* Moses commanded the people of Israel, saying, 'This is the land that You shall inherit by lot, which the LORD has commanded to give to the nine and one-half tribes.
- 14 *For the tribe of the children of Reuben according to the house of their fathers, and the tribe of the children of Gad according to the house of their fathers, have received their inheritance; and half the tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance:* For the tribe of the people of Reuben by fathers' houses and the tribe of the people of Gad by their fathers' houses have received their inheritance, and also the half-tribe of Manasseh has received its inheritance.
- 15 *The two tribes and the half tribe have received their inheritance on this side Jordan near Jericho eastward, toward the sunrising.* The two tribes and the half-tribe have received their inheritance beyond the Jordan east of Jericho, toward the sunrise.'
- 16 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 17 *These are the names of the men which shall divide the land unto you: Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun.* 'These are the names of the men who shall divide the land to you for inheritance: Eleazar the priest and Joshua the son of Nun.

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| 18 | <i>And ye shall take one prince of every tribe, to divide the land by inheritance.</i> | You shall take one chief from every tribe to divide the land for inheritance. |
| 19 | <i>And the names of the men are these: Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh.</i> | These are the names of the men: Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh. |
| 20 | <i>And of the tribe of the children of Simeon, Shemuel the son of Ammihud.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Simeon, Shemuel the son of Ammihud. |
| 21 | <i>Of the tribe of Benjamin, Elidad the son of Chislon.</i> | Of the tribe of Benjamin, Elidad the son of Chislon. |
| 22 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Dan, Bukki the son of Jogli.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Dan, Bukki the son of Jogli. |
| 23 | <i>The prince of the children of Joseph, for the tribe of the children of Manasseh, Hanniel the son of Ephod.</i> | Of the people of Joseph: of the tribe of the people of Manasseh, Hanniel the son of Ephod. |
| 24 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Ephraim, Kemuel the son of Shiphtan.</i> | of the tribe of the people of Ephraim, Kemuel the son of Shiphtan. |
| 25 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Zebulun, Elizaphan the son of Parnach.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Zebulun, Elizaphan the son of Parnach. |
| 26 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Issachar, Paltiel the son of Azzan.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Issachar, Paltiel the son of Azzan. |
| 27 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Asher, Ahihud the son of Shelomi.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Asher, Ahihud the son of Shelomi. |
| 28 | <i>And the prince of the tribe of the children of Naphtali, Pedahel the son of Ammihud.</i> | Of the tribe of the people of Naphtali, Pedahel the son of Ammihud.' |

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| 29 <i>These are they whom the LORD commanded to divide the inheritance unto the children of Israel in the land of Canaan.</i> | These are the men whom the LORD commanded to divide the inheritance for the people of Israel in the land of Canaan. |
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Words in this chapter:

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Gen 17:8; Ps 105:11
- v5 — Josh 15:4
- v11 — Deut 3:17; 2 Kgs 23:33
- v14 — Num 32:33
- v17 — Josh 14:1

Chapter 35

The LORD commands Israel to give the Levites forty-eight cities with their pasturelands, including six cities of refuge where a person who kills another unintentionally may flee from the avenger of blood. The distinction between murder and manslaughter is defined, and the murderer must be put to death.

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| 1 <i>And the LORD spake unto Moses in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, saying,</i> | The LORD spoke to Moses in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying, |
| 2 <i>Command the children of Israel, that they give unto the Levites of the inheritance of their possession cities to dwell in; and ye shall give also unto the Levites suburbs for the cities round about them.</i> | 'Command the people of Israel to give to the Levites some of the inheritance of their possession as cities to dwell in. And You shall give to the Levites pasturelands around the cities. |
| 3 <i>And the cities shall they have to dwell in; and the pastures of them shall be for their cattle, and for their goods, and for all their beasts.</i> | The cities shall be theirs to dwell in. Their pasturelands shall be for their livestock and for their property and for all their animals. |

- 4 *And the suburbs of the cities, which ye shall give unto the Levites, shall reach from the wall of the city and outward a thousand cubits round about.* The pasturelands of the cities, which You shall give to the Levites, shall reach from the wall of the city outward a thousand cubits all around.
- 5 *And ye shall measure from without the city on the east side two thousand cubits, and on the south side two thousand cubits, and on the west side two thousand cubits, and on the north side two thousand cubits; and the city shall be in the midst: this shall be to them the suburbs of the cities.* you shall measure, outside the city, on the east side 2,000 cubits, on the south side 2,000 cubits, on the west side 2,000 cubits, and on the north side 2,000 cubits, the city being in the center. This shall belong to them as pastureland for their cities.
- 6 *And among the cities which ye shall give unto the Levites there shall be six cities for refuge, which ye shall appoint for the manslayer, that he may flee thither: and to them ye shall add forty and two cities.* The cities that You give to the Levites shall be the six cities of refuge, where You shall permit the manslayer to flee, and in addition to them You shall give 42 cities.
- 7 *So all the cities which ye shall give to the Levites shall be forty and eight cities: them shall ye give with their suburbs.* All the cities that You give to the Levites shall be 48, with their pasturelands.
- 8 *And the cities which ye shall give shall be of the possession of the children of Israel: from them that have many ye shall give many; but from them that have few ye shall give few: every one shall give of his cities unto the Levites according to his inheritance which he inheriteth.* as for the cities that You shall give from the possession of the people of Israel, from the larger tribes you shall take many, and from the smaller tribes You shall take few; each, in proportion to its inheritance that it inherits, shall give of its cities to the Levites.'
- 9 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 10 *Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye be come over Jordan into the land of Canaan;* 'Speak to the people of Israel and say to them, when you cross the Jordan into the land of Canaan,

- 11 *Then ye shall appoint you cities to be cities of refuge for you; that the slayer may flee thither, which killeth any person at unawares.* then You shall select cities to be cities of refuge for You, that the manslayer who kills any person without intent may flee there.
- 12 *And they shall be unto you cities for refuge from the avenger; that the manslayer die not, until he stand before the congregation in judgment.* The cities shall be for You a refuge from the avenger, that the manslayer may not die until He stands before the congregation for judgment.
- 13 *And of these cities which ye shall give six cities shall ye have for refuge.* of the cities that You give, You shall have six cities of refuge.
- 14 *Ye shall give three cities on this side Jordan, and three cities shall ye give in the land of Canaan, which shall be cities of refuge.* You shall give three cities beyond the Jordan, and three cities in the land of Canaan, to be cities of refuge.
- 15 *These six cities shall be a refuge, both for the children of Israel, and for the stranger, and for the sojourner among them: that every one that killeth any person unawares may flee thither.* These six cities shall be for refuge for the people of Israel, and for the stranger and for the sojourner among them, that anyone who kills any person without intent may flee there.
- 16 *And if he smite him with an instrument of iron, so that he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.* But if He struck Him down with an iron object, so that He died, He is a murderer. The murderer shall be put to death.
- 17 *And if he smite him with throwing a stone, wherewith he may die, and he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.* if He struck Him down with a stone in hand, by which a man may die. He died, he is a murderer. The murderer shall be put to death.
- 18 *Or if he smite him with an hand weapon of wood, wherewith he may die, and he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.* Or if He struck Him down with a wooden weapon in hand, by which a man may die. He died, he is a murderer. The murderer shall be put to death.

- 19 *The revenger of blood himself shall slay the murderer: when he meeteth him, he shall slay him.* The avenger of blood shall Himself put the murderer to death; when He meets Him, He shall put Him to death.
- 20 *But if he thrust him of hatred, or hurl at him by laying of wait, that he die;* if He pushed Him out of hatred or hurled something at Him, lying in wait, so that He died,
- 21 *Or in enmity smite him with his hand, that he die: he that smote him shall surely be put to death; for he is a murderer: the revenger of blood shall slay the murderer, when he meeteth him.* or in enmity struck Him down with His hand, so that He died, then He who struck the blow shall be put to death. He is a murderer. The avenger of blood shall put the murderer to death when He meets Him.
- 22 *But if he thrust him suddenly without enmity, or have cast upon him any thing without laying of wait,* But if He pushed Him suddenly without enmity, or hurled anything on Him without lying in wait
- 23 *Or with any stone, wherewith a man may die, seeing him not, and cast it upon him, that he die, and was not his enemy, neither sought his harm:* or used a stone that could cause death, and without seeing Him dropped it on Him, so that He died, though He was not His enemy and did not seek His harm,
- 24 *Then the congregation shall judge between the slayer and the revenger of blood according to these judgments:* then the congregation shall judge between the manslayer and the avenger of blood, in accordance with these rules.
- 25 *And the congregation shall deliver the slayer out of the hand of the revenger of blood, and the congregation shall restore him to the city of his refuge, whither he was fled: and he shall abide in it unto the death of the high priest, which was anointed with the holy oil.* the congregation shall rescue the manslayer from the hand of the avenger of blood, and the congregation shall return Him to His city of refuge to which He had fled. He shall live in it until the death of the high priest who was anointed with the holy oil.
- 26 *But if the slayer shall at any time come without the border of the city of his refuge, whither he was fled;* But if the manslayer shall at any time go beyond the boundaries of His city of refuge to which He fled,

- 27 *And the revenger of blood find him without the borders of the city of his refuge, and the revenger of blood kill the slayer; he shall not be guilty of blood:* the avenger of blood finds Him outside the boundaries of His city of refuge, and the avenger of blood kills the manslayer, He shall not be guilty of blood.
- 28 *Because he should have remained in the city of his refuge until the death of the high priest: but after the death of the high priest the slayer shall return into the land of his possession.* For He must remain in His city of refuge until the death of the high priest, but after the death of the high priest the manslayer may return to the land of His possession.
- 29 *So these things shall be for a statute of judgment unto you throughout your generations in all your dwellings.* these things shall be for a statute and rule for You throughout Your generations in all Your dwelling places.
- 30 *Whoso killeth any person, the murderer shall be put to death by the mouth of witnesses: but one witness shall not testify against any person to cause him to die.* If anyone kills a person, the murderer shall be put to death on the evidence of witnesses. But no person shall be put to death on the testimony of one witness.
- 31 *Moreover ye shall take no satisfaction for the life of a murderer, which is guilty of death: but he shall be surely put to death.* Moreover, You shall accept no ransom for the life of a murderer who is guilty of death. But He shall be put to death.
- 32 *And ye shall take no satisfaction for him that is fled to the city of his refuge, that he should come again to dwell in the land, until the death of the priest.* you shall accept no ransom for Him who has fled to His city of refuge, that He may return to dwell in the land before the death of the high priest.
- 33 *So ye shall not pollute the land wherein ye are: for blood it defileth the land: and the land cannot be cleansed of the blood that is shed therein, but by the blood of him that shed it.* You shall not pollute the land in which You live, for blood pollutes the land, and no atonement can be made for the land for the blood that is shed in it, except by the blood of the one who shed it.

- 34
- Defile not therefore the land which ye shall inhabit, wherein I dwell: for I the LORD dwell among the children of Israel.*

You shall not defile the land in which You live, in the midst of which I dwell, for I the LORD dwell in the midst of the people of Israel.'

Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v8** — Num 33:54; Num 26:54
- v11** — Ex 21:13
- v16** — Lev 24:17
- v20** — Ex 21:14; Deut 19:11
- v24** — Josh 20:6
- v25** — Ex 29:7
- v29** — Num 27:11
- v30** — Heb 10:28; Matt 18:16; Deut 19:15
- v33** — Luke 11:50-51; Ps 106:38
- v34** — Num 5:3

Chapter 36

The clan leaders of Manasseh raise a concern that the inheritance of Zelophehad's daughters will transfer to another tribe if they marry outside their tribe. The LORD commands that women who inherit land must marry within their father's tribe, and Zelophehad's daughters marry their cousins.

- 1 *And the chief fathers of the families of the children of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of the sons of Joseph, came near, and spake before Moses, and before the princes, the chief fathers of the children of Israel:* The heads of the fathers' houses of the clan of the people of Gilead the son of Machir, son of Manasseh, from the clans of the people of Joseph, came near and spoke before Moses and before the chiefs, the heads of the fathers' houses of the people of Israel.
- 2 *And they said, The LORD commanded my lord to give the land for an inheritance by lot to the children of Israel: and my lord was commanded by the LORD to give the inheritance of Zelophehad our brother unto his daughters.* They said, 'The LORD commanded my lord to give the land for inheritance by lot to the people of Israel, and my lord was commanded by the LORD to give the inheritance of Zelophehad our brother to His daughters.
- 3 *And if they be married to any of the sons of the other tribes of the children of Israel, then shall their inheritance be taken from the inheritance of our fathers, and shall be put to the inheritance of the tribe whereunto they are received: so shall it be taken from the lot of our inheritance.* But if they are married to any of the sons of the other tribes of the people of Israel, then their inheritance will be taken from the inheritance of our fathers and added to the inheritance of the tribe into which they marry, so it will be taken away from our allotted inheritance.
- 4 *And when the jubile of the children of Israel shall be, then shall their inheritance be put unto the inheritance of the tribe whereunto they are received: and their inheritance shall be taken away from the inheritance of the tribe of our fathers.* when the jubilee of the people of Israel comes, then their inheritance will be added to the inheritance of the tribe into which they marry. Their inheritance will be taken from the inheritance of the tribe of our fathers.'
- 5 *And Moses commanded the children of Israel according to the word of the LORD, saying, The tribe of the sons of Joseph hath said well.* Moses commanded the people of Israel according to the word of the LORD, saying, 'The tribe of the sons of Joseph is right.

- 6 *This is the thing which the LORD doth command concerning the daughters of Zelophehad, saying, Let them marry to whom they think best; only to the family of the tribe of their father shall they marry.* This is what the LORD commands concerning the daughters of Zelophehad: let them marry whom they think best, only they shall marry within the clan of the tribe of their father.
- 7 *So shall not the inheritance of the children of Israel remove from tribe to tribe: for every one of the children of Israel shall keep himself to the inheritance of the tribe of his fathers.* The inheritance of the people of Israel shall not be transferred from one tribe to another, for every one of the people of Israel shall hold on to the inheritance of the tribe of His fathers.
- 8 *And every daughter, that possesseth an inheritance in any tribe of the children of Israel, shall be wife unto one of the family of the tribe of her father, that the children of Israel may enjoy every man the inheritance of his fathers.* every daughter who possesses an inheritance in any tribe of the people of Israel shall be wife to one of the clan of the tribe of her father, so that every one of the people of Israel may possess the inheritance of His fathers.
- 9 *Neither shall the inheritance remove from one tribe to another tribe; but every one of the tribes of the children of Israel shall keep himself to his own inheritance.* So no inheritance shall be transferred from one tribe to another, for each of the tribes of the people of Israel shall hold on to its own inheritance.'
- 10 *Even as the LORD commanded Moses, so did the daughters of Zelophehad:* The daughters of Zelophehad did as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 11 *For Mahlah, Tirzah, and Hoglah, and Milcah, and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad, were married unto their father's brothers' sons:* Mahlah, Tirzah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad, married sons of their father's brothers.
- 12 *And they were married into the families of the sons of Manasseh the son of Joseph, and their inheritance remained in the tribe of the family of their father.* They were married into the clans of the sons of Manasseh the son of Joseph. Their inheritance remained in the tribe of their father's clan.

- 13

These are the commandments and the judgments, which the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses unto the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.
- These are the commandments and the rules that the LORD commanded through Moses to the people of Israel in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.

Words in this chapter:

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v6 — Num 36:12

v7 — 1 Kgs 21:3

v8 — 1 Chr 23:22

Deuteronomy

Author: Moses — the book presents itself as Moses's own words (Deut 1:1), and Christ quoted it three times against Satan (Matt 4), attributing its authority to Moses.

Date written: c. 1405 BC, in the final weeks of Moses's life on the plains of Moab.

Written to: The second generation of Israelites — those who were born in the wilderness and had not witnessed the Exodus firsthand.

Setting: Forty years of wandering are ending. The generation that left Egypt has died. A new generation stands on the threshold of Canaan. Moses, forbidden from entering the land, gives three farewell sermons to prepare them.

Where this sits historically: c. 1406 BC on the plains of Moab, just before Israel crosses the Jordan; Egypt is ruled by Amenhotep III and the late 18th dynasty.

Contemporaries: Egypt's Amenhotep III; the Hittites under Suppiluliuma I; the Canaanite city-states fragmented. Joshua, Moses's successor, begins his own narrative immediately after Moses's death here.

Big themes:

- Remember — Moses repeatedly commands the people to remember what God did; covenant faithfulness depends on remembering grace received
- The Shema — "Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD" (6:4) is the foundational confession of Israel's faith
- Blessings and curses — obedience brings life and blessing in the land; disobedience brings the curse and ultimately exile (ch. 28)
- Love as the foundation of the law — the commandments are not arbitrary rules but the expression of a covenant relationship with a God who first loved Israel
- A prophet like Moses — God's promise to raise up another prophet (18:15) is fulfilled in Christ (Acts 3:22)

Key passages: Deut 4:39; 6:4–5; 18:15; 28:1–2; 30:19–20

How it fits: Deuteronomy is the covenant document that governs everything from Joshua to 2 Kings. Every judgment on Israel in the historical books is measured against its standards. Jesus quotes it more than any other OT book. It ends with Moses's death and sets the stage for Joshua to lead Israel into the land.

Chapter 1

Moses begins his farewell address to Israel on the plains of Moab, recounting their journey from Horeb to Kadesh-barnea. He recalls appointing judges, the sending of the spies, and the people's refusal to enter the land, which resulted in the entire adult generation being

condemned to die in the wilderness.

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| <p>1 <i>These be the words which Moses spake unto all Israel on this side Jordan in the wilderness, in the plain over against the Red sea, between Paran, and Tophel, and Laban, and Hazeroth, and Dizahab.</i></p> <p>2 <i>(There are eleven days' journey from Horeb by the way of mount Seir unto Kadeshbarnea.)</i></p> <p>3 <i>And it came to pass in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first day of the month, that Moses spake unto the children of Israel, according unto all that the LORD had given him in commandment unto them;</i></p> <p>4 <i>After he had slain Sihon the king of the Amorites, which dwelt in Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan, which dwelt at Astaroth in Edrei:</i></p> <p>5 <i>On this side Jordan, in the land of Moab, began Moses to declare this law, saying,</i></p> <p>6 <i>The LORD our God spake unto us in Horeb, saying, Ye have dwelt long enough in this mount:</i></p> <p>7 <i>Turn you, and take your journey, and go to the mount of the Amorites, and unto all the places nigh thereunto, in the plain, in the hills, and in the vale, and in the south, and by the sea side, to the land of the Canaanites, and unto Lebanon, unto the great river, the river Euphrates.</i></p> | <p>These are the words that Moses spoke to all Israel in the wilderness beyond the Jordan—in the plain over against the Red sea, between Paran and Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth, and Dizahab.</p> <p>It is eleven days' journey from Horeb by the way of Mount Seir to Kadesh-barnea.</p> <p>In the fortieth year, on the first day of the eleventh month, Moses spoke to the people of Israel according to all that the LORD had given Him in command to them,</p> <p>after he had defeated Sihon the king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan, who lived in Ashtaroth and in Edrei.</p> <p>Beyond the Jordan, in the land of Moab, Moses began to explain this law, saying,</p> <p>"The LORD our God said to us in Horeb, "You have stayed long enough at this mountain.</p> <p>Turn and set out on Your journey, and go to the hill country of the Amorites and to all their neighbors in the Arabah, in the hill country, in the lowland, in the south, and by the seacoast, the land of the Canaanites, and Lebanon, as far as the great river, the river Euphrates.</p> |
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- 8 *Behold, I have set the land before you: go in and possess the land which the LORD sware unto your fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, to give unto them and to their seed after them.* See, I have set the land before You. Go in and take possession of the land that the LORD swore to Your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give to them and to their seed after them."
- 9 *And I spake unto you at that time, saying, I am not able to bear you myself alone:* I said to You at that time, "I am not able to bear You by myself.
- 10 *The LORD your God hath multiplied you, and, behold, ye are this day as the stars of heaven for multitude.* The LORD Your God has multiplied You, and You are today as numerous as the stars of heaven.
- 11 *(The LORD God of your fathers make you a thousand times so many more as ye are, and bless you, as he hath promised you!)* May the LORD, the God of Your fathers, make You a thousand times as many as You are and bless You, as He has promised You!
- 12 *How can I myself alone bear your cumbrance, and your burden, and your strife?* How can I bear by myself the burden and weight and strife of You?
- 13 *Take you wise men, and understanding, and known among your tribes, and I will make them rulers over you.* Choose wise, understanding, and experienced men from Your tribes. I will appoint them as Your heads."
- 14 *And ye answered me, and said, The thing which thou hast spoken is good for us to do.* You answered me, "The thing that You have spoken is good for us to do."
- 15 *So I took the chief of your tribes, wise men, and known, and made them heads over you, captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, and captains over fifties, and captains over tens, and officers among your tribes.* So I took the heads of Your tribes, wise and experienced men, and set them as heads over You, commanders of thousands, commanders of hundreds, commanders of fifties, commanders of tens, and officers throughout Your tribes.

- 16 *And I charged your judges at that time, saying, Hear the causes between your brethren, and judge righteously between every man and his brother, and the stranger that is with him.* I charged Your judges at that time, "Hear the cases between Your brothers, and judge righteously between a man and his brother and the stranger who is with Him.
- 17 *Ye shall not respect persons in judgment; but ye shall hear the small as well as the great; ye shall not be afraid of the face of man; for the judgment is God's: and the cause that is too hard for you, bring it unto me, and I will hear it.* You shall not be partial in judgment. You shall hear the small and the great alike. You shall not be intimidated by anyone, for the judgment is God's. And the case that is too hard for You, You shall bring to me. I will hear it."
- 18 *And I commanded you at that time all the things which ye should do.* I commanded You at that time all the things that You should do.
- 19 *And when we departed from Horeb, we went through all that great and terrible wilderness, which ye saw by the way of the mountain of the Amorites, as the LORD our God commanded us; and we came to Kadeshbarnea.* Then we set out from Horeb and went through all that great and terrifying wilderness that You saw, on the way to the hill country of the Amorites, as the LORD our God commanded us. And we came to Kadesh-barnea.
- 20 *And I said unto you, Ye are come unto the mountain of the Amorites, which the LORD our God doth give unto us.* I said to You, "You have come to the hill country of the Amorites, which the LORD our God is giving us.
- 21 *Behold, the LORD thy God hath set the land before thee: go up and possess it, as the LORD God of thy fathers hath said unto thee; fear not, neither be discouraged.* See, the LORD Your God has set the land before You. Go up, take possession, as the LORD, the God of Your fathers, has told You. Do not fear or be dismayed."
- 22 *And ye came near unto me every one of you, and said, We will send men before us, and they shall search us out the land, and bring us word again by what way we must go up, and into what cities we shall come.* Then all of You came near me and said, "Let us send men before us, that they may explore the land for us and bring us word again of the way by which we must go up and the cities into which we shall come."

- 23 *And the saying pleased me well: and I took twelve men of you, one of a tribe:* The plan seemed good to me. I took twelve men from You, one man from each tribe.
- 24 *And they turned and went up into the mountain, and came unto the valley of Eshcol, and searched it out.* They turned and went up into the hill country, and came to the Valley of Eshcol and spied it out.
- 25 *And they took of the fruit of the land in their hands, and brought it down unto us, and brought us word again, and said, It is a good land which the LORD our God doth give us.* they took in their hands some of the fruit of the land and brought it down to us, and brought us word again and said, "It is a good land that the LORD our God is giving us."
- 26 *Notwithstanding ye would not go up, but rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God:* Yet You would not go up, but rebelled against the command of the LORD Your God.
- 27 *And ye murmured in your tents, and said, Because the LORD hated us, he hath brought us forth out of the land of Egypt, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us.* you grumbled in Your tents and said, "Because the LORD hated us He has brought us out of the land of Egypt, to give us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us.
- 28 *Whither shall we go up? our brethren have discouraged our heart, saying, The people is greater and taller than we; the cities are great and walled up to heaven; and moreover we have seen the sons of the Anakims there.* Where are we going up? Our brothers have made our hearts melt, saying, "The people are greater and taller than we are. The cities are great and fortified up to heaven. And besides, we have seen the sons of the Anakim there.' "
- 29 *Then I said unto you, Dread not, neither be afraid of them.* Then I said to You, "Do not be in dread or afraid of them.
- 30 *The LORD your God which goeth before you, he shall fight for you, according to all that he did for you in Egypt before your eyes;* The LORD Your God Who goes before You will Himself fight for You, just as He did for You in Egypt before Your eyes,

- 31 *And in the wilderness, where thou hast seen how that the LORD thy God bare thee, as a man doth bear his son, in all the way that ye went, until ye came into this place.* in the wilderness, where You have seen how the LORD Your God carried You, as a man carries his son, all the way that you went until You came to this place."
- 32 *Yet in this thing ye did not believe the LORD your God,* Yet in spite of this word You did not believe the LORD Your God,
- 33 *Who went in the way before you, to search you out a place to pitch your tents in, in fire by night, to shew you by what way ye should go, and in a cloud by day.* who went before You in the way to seek You out a place to camp, in fire by night and in the cloud by day, to show You by what way You should go.
- 34 *And the LORD heard the voice of your words, and was wroth, and sware, saying,* the LORD heard Your words and was angry. He swore,
- 35 *Surely there shall not one of these men of this evil generation see that good land, which I sware to give unto your fathers,* "Not one of these men of this evil generation shall see the good land that I swore to give to Your fathers,
- 36 *Save Caleb the son of Jephunneh; he shall see it, and to him will I give the land that he hath trodden upon, and to his children, because he hath wholly followed the LORD.* except Caleb the son of Jephunneh. He shall see it, and to Him and to His children I will give the land on which He has trodden, because He has wholly followed the LORD!"
- 37 *Also the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, saying, Thou also shalt not go in thither.* Even with me the LORD was angry on Your account and said, "You also shall not go in there.
- 38 *But Joshua the son of Nun, which standeth before thee, he shall go in thither: encourage him: for he shall cause Israel to inherit it.* Joshua the son of Nun, who stands before you, he shall enter. Encourage him, for he shall cause Israel to inherit it.

- 39 *Moreover your little ones, which ye said should be a prey, and your children, which in that day had no knowledge between good and evil, they shall go in thither, and unto them will I give it, and they shall possess it.* as for your little ones, who you said would become prey, and your children, who today have no knowledge of good or evil, they shall go in there. And to them I will give it. They shall possess it.
- 40 *But as for you, turn you, and take your journey into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea.* But as for you, turn around and journey into the wilderness in the direction of the Red Sea."
- 41 *Then ye answered and said unto me, We have sinned against the LORD, we will go up and fight, according to all that the LORD our God commanded us. And when ye had girded on every man his weapons of war, ye were ready to go up into the hill country.* Then You answered me, "We have sinned against the LORD. We ourselves will go up and fight, just as the LORD our God commanded us." And every one of you fastened on his weapons of war and thought it easy to go up into the hill country.
- 42 *And the LORD said unto me, Say unto them, Go not up, neither fight; for I am not among you; lest ye be smitten before your enemies.* the LORD said to me, "Say to them, 'Do not go up or fight, for I am not among You, lest You be defeated before Your enemies.' "
- 43 *So I spake unto you; and ye would not hear, but rebelled against the commandment of the LORD, and went presumptuously up into the hill country.* So I spoke to You, and You would not listen. You rebelled against the command of the LORD and presumptuously went up into the hill country.
- 44 *And the Amorites, which dwelt in that mountain, came out against you, and chased you, as bees do, and destroyed you in Seir, even unto Hormah.* Then the Amorites who lived in that hill country came out against You and chased You as bees do and beat You down in Seir as far as Hormah.
- 45 *And ye returned and wept before the LORD; but the LORD would not hearken to your voice, nor give ear unto you.* you returned and wept before the LORD. But the LORD did not listen to Your voice or give ear to You.

- 46 *So ye abode in Kadesh many days, according unto the days that ye abode there.* *So You remained at Kadesh many days, all the days that You remained there.*
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Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Laban (*LAY-ban*) — Rebekah's brother and Jacob's uncle — Jacob worked fourteen years for him to marry his daughters; his name means 'white.'

Cross-References:

- v6 — Ex 3:1
- v7 — Deut 11:24; Josh 10:40
- v8 — Gen 15:18; Gen 12:7; Gen 26:3-4; Gen 13:14-15; Gen 17:7-8
- v10 — Gen 15:5; Gen 22:17; Deut 10:22; Ex 32:13; Deut 28:62
- v11 — Ps 115:14; Gen 22:17; Num 6:27; Gen 26:4; Gen 49:25
- v17 — Deut 16:19; Ex 18:26; Jas 2:9; 2 Chr 19:6; Lev 19:15
- v19 — Deut 1:2; Deut 8:15; Jer 2:6
- v30 — Ex 14:14; Neh 4:20; Rom 8:37; Rom 8:31; Josh 10:42
- v31 — Isa 46:3-4; Acts 13:18; Deut 32:10-12; Isa 63:9; Hos 11:3-4
- v32 — Ps 106:24; Jude 1:5; Heb 3:18-19
- v37 — Deut 4:21; Num 20:12; Deut 34:4
- v39 — Isa 7:15-16; Num 14:3

Chapter 2

Moses recounts how Israel wandered in the wilderness for thirty-eight years until the generation of fighting men had perished. He recalls their passage around Edom, Moab, and Ammon -- lands the LORD had given to Esau and Lot's descendants -- and Israel's defeat of

Sihon king of Heshbon.

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| <p>1 <i>Then we turned, and took our journey into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea, as the LORD spake unto me: and we compassed mount Seir many days.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And the LORD spake unto me, saying,</i></p> <p>3 <i>Ye have compassed this mountain long enough: turn you northward.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And command thou the people, saying, Ye are to pass through the coast of your brethren the children of Esau, which dwell in Seir; and they shall be afraid of you: take ye good heed unto yourselves therefore:</i></p> <p>5 <i>Meddle not with them; for I will not give you of their land, no, not so much as a foot breadth; because I have given mount Seir unto Esau for a possession.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Ye shall buy meat of them for money, that ye may eat; and ye shall also buy water of them for money, that ye may drink.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For the LORD thy God hath blessed thee in all the works of thine hand: he knoweth thy walking through this great wilderness: these forty years the LORD thy God hath been with thee; thou hast lacked nothing.</i></p> | <p>Then we turned and journeyed into the wilderness in the direction of the Red Sea, as the LORD told me. And for many days we traveled around Mount Seir.</p> <p>the LORD said to me,</p> <p>"You have been traveling around this mountain long enough. Turn northward.</p> <p>command the people, 'You are about to pass through the territory of your brothers, the people of Esau, who live in Seir. They will be afraid of you. So be very careful.</p> <p>Do not contend with them, for I will not give you any of their land, not even as much as a foot's breadth, because I have given Mount Seir to Esau as a possession.</p> <p>You shall purchase food from them with money so that you may eat, and you shall also buy water from them with money so that you may drink."</p> <p>For the LORD Your God has blessed You in all the work of Your hands. He knows Your going through this great wilderness. These forty years the LORD Your God has been with You. You have lacked nothing.'</p> |
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- 8 *And when we passed by from our brethren the children of Esau, which dwelt in Seir, through the way of the plain from Elath, and from Eziongaber, we turned and passed by the way of the wilderness of Moab.* So we went on away from our brothers the people of Esau who live in Seir, away from the Arabah road from Elath and Ezion-geber. And we turned and went in the direction of the wilderness of Moab.
- 9 *And the LORD said unto me, Distress not the Moabites, neither contend with them in battle: for I will not give thee of their land for a possession; because I have given Ar unto the children of Lot for a possession.* the LORD said to me, "Do not harass Moab or contend with them in battle, for I will not give You any of their land for a possession, because I have given Ar to the people of Lot for a possession."
- 10 *The Emims dwelt therein in times past, a people great, and many, and tall, as the Anakims;* (The Emim formerly lived there, a great and numerous people, tall as the Anakim.
- 11 *Which also were accounted giants, as the Anakims; but the Moabites call them Emims.* Like the Anakim they are also counted as giants, but the Moabites call them Emim.
- 12 *The Horims also dwelt in Seir beforetime; but the children of Esau succeeded them, when they had destroyed them from before them, and dwelt in their stead; as Israel did unto the land of his possession, which the LORD gave unto them.* The Horites also lived in Seir formerly, but the people of Esau dispossessed them and destroyed them from before them and settled in their place, as Israel did to the land of their possession, which the LORD gave to them.)
- 13 *Now rise up, said I, and get you over the brook Zered. And we went over the brook Zered.* "Now rise up and go over the brook Zered." So we went over the brook Zered.
- 14 *And the space in which we came from Kadeshbarnea, until we were come over the brook Zered, was thirty and eight years; until all the generation of the men of war were wasted out from among the host, as the LORD sware unto them.* the time from our leaving Kadesh-barnea until we crossed the brook Zered was thirty-eight years, until the entire generation of warriors had perished from the camp, as the LORD had sworn to them.

- 15 *For indeed the hand of the LORD was against them, to destroy them from among the host, until they were consumed.* For indeed the hand of the LORD was against them, to destroy them from the camp, until they had perished.
- 16 *So it came to pass, when all the men of war were consumed and dead from among the people,* So as soon as all the men of war had perished and were dead from among the people,
- 17 *That the LORD spake unto me, saying,* the LORD said to me,
- 18 *Thou art to pass over through Ar, the coast of Moab, this day:* "Today You are to cross the border of Moab at Ar.
- 19 *And when thou comest nigh over against the children of Ammon, distress them not, nor meddle with them: for I will not give thee of the land of the children of Ammon any possession; because I have given it unto the children of Lot for a possession.* when you approach the territory of the people of Ammon, do not harass them or contend with them, for I will not give you any of the land of the people of Ammon as a possession, because I have given it to the people of Lot for a possession."
- 20 *(That also was accounted a land of giants: giants dwelt therein in old time; and the Ammonites call them Zamzummims;* (It is also counted as a land of giants. Giants formerly lived there—but the Ammonites call them Zamzummim—
- 21 *A people great, and many, and tall, as the Anakims; but the LORD destroyed them before them; and they succeeded them, and dwelt in their stead:* a people great and numerous and tall as the Anakim; but the LORD destroyed them before them. They dispossessed them and settled in their place,
- 22 *As he did to the children of Esau, which dwelt in Seir, when he destroyed the Horims from before them; and they succeeded them, and dwelt in their stead even unto this day:* just as he had done for the people of Esau, who live in Seir, when he destroyed the Horites before them. They dispossessed them and settled in their place even to this day.

- 23 *And the Avims which dwelt in Hazerim, even unto Azzah, the Caphtorims, which came forth out of Caphtor, destroyed them, and dwelt in their stead.)* As for the Avvim, who lived in villages as far as Gaza, the Caphtorim, who came from Caphtor, destroyed them and settled in their place.)
- 24 *Rise ye up, take your journey, and pass over the river Arnon: behold, I have given into thine hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land: begin to possess it, and contend with him in battle.* "Rise up, set out on your journey and go over the Valley of the Arnon. See, I have given into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land. Begin to take possession of it and contend with him in battle.
- 25 *This day will I begin to put the dread of thee and the fear of thee upon the nations that are under the whole heaven, who shall hear report of thee, and shall tremble, and be in anguish because of thee.* This day I will begin to put the dread and fear of you on the peoples who are under the whole heaven, who shall hear the report of you and shall tremble and be in anguish because of you."
- 26 *And I sent messengers out of the wilderness of Kedemoth unto Sihon king of Heshbon with words of peace, saying,* So I sent messengers from the wilderness of Kedemoth to Sihon the king of Heshbon, with words of peace, saying,
- 27 *Let me pass through thy land: I will go along by the high way, I will neither turn unto the right hand nor to the left.* "Let me pass through your land. I will go only along the road. I will turn aside neither to the right nor to the left.
- 28 *Thou shalt sell me meat for money, that I may eat; and give me water for money, that I may drink: only I will pass through on my feet;* You shall sell me food for money, that I may eat, and give me water for money, that I may drink. Only let me pass through on foot,
- 29 *(As the children of Esau which dwell in Seir, and the Moabites which dwell in Ar, did unto me;) until I shall pass over Jordan into the land which the LORD our God giveth us.* as the people of Esau who live in Seir and the Moabites who live in Ar did for me, until I cross the Jordan into the land the LORD our God is giving us."

- 30 *But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us pass by him: for the LORD thy God hardened his spirit, and made his heart obstinate, that he might deliver him into thy hand, as appeareth this day.* But Sihon the king of Heshbon would not let us pass through, for the LORD Your God hardened His spirit and made His heart obstinate, that He might give Him into Your hand, as He is this day.
- 31 *And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have begun to give Sihon and his land before thee: begin to possess, that thou mayest inherit his land.* the LORD said to me, "See, I have begun to give Sihon and His land over to You. Begin to take possession, that You may occupy His land."
- 32 *Then Sihon came out against us, he and all his people, to fight at Jahaz.* Then Sihon came out against us, He and all His people, to battle at Jahaz.
- 33 *And the LORD our God delivered him before us; and we smote him, and his sons, and all his people.* the LORD our God gave Him over to us. We defeated Him and His sons and all His people.
- 34 *And we took all his cities at that time, and utterly destroyed the men, and the women, and the little ones, of every city, we left none to remain:* we captured all His cities at that time and devoted to destruction every city—men, women, and children. We left no survivors.
- 35 *Only the cattle we took for a prey unto ourselves, and the spoil of the cities which we took.* Only the livestock we took as plunder for ourselves, with the spoil of the cities that we captured.
- 36 *From Aroer, which is by the brink of the river of Arnon, and from the city that is by the river, even unto Gilead, there was not one city too strong for us: the LORD our God delivered all unto us:* From Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, and from the city that is in the valley, as far as Gilead, there was not a city too high for us. The LORD our God gave all into our hands.
- 37 *Only unto the land of the children of Ammon thou camest not, and unto all the places by the river Jabbok, and the cities in the mountains, and wheresoever the LORD our God forbad us.* Only to the land of the people of Ammon you did not draw near, that is, to all the banks of the river Jabbok and the cities of the hill country, wherever the LORD our God had forbidden us.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — Num 21:4; Deut 1:40

v3 — Deut 1:6; Deut 2:14

v5 — Gen 36:8; Josh 24:4

v7 — Luke 22:35; Neh 9:21; Deut 8:2-4; Deut 29:5; Ps 90:17

v9 — Gen 19:36-37; Num 21:15

v14 — Num 26:64-65; Num 14:28-35

v23 — Gen 10:14; Josh 13:3

v25 — Deut 11:25; Ex 15:14-16; Deut 28:10; Ex 23:27; Ps 105:38

v30 — Num 21:23; Ex 4:21

v34 — 1 Sam 15:3; Deut 7:2

v36 — Josh 13:9; Deut 4:48; Deut 3:12

v37 — Num 21:24; Gen 32:22; Deut 3:16

Chapter 3

Moses recounts the defeat of Og king of Bashan and the division of the conquered land east of the Jordan to Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. He tells how he pleaded with the LORD to let him cross into the Promised Land, but the LORD refused and told him to commission Joshua instead.

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| <p>¹ <i>Then we turned, and went up the way to Bashan: and Og the king of Bashan came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei.</i></p> | <p>Then we turned and went up the road to Bashan. And Og the king of Bashan came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei.</p> |
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- 2 *And the LORD said unto me, Fear him not: for I will deliver him, and all his people, and his land, into thy hand; and thou shalt do unto him as thou didst unto Sihon king of the Amorites, which dwelt at Heshbon.* But the LORD said to me, "Do not fear Him, for I have given Him and all His people and His land into Your hand. And You shall do to Him as You did to Sihon the king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon."
- 3 *So the LORD our God delivered into our hands Og also, the king of Bashan, and all his people: and we smote him until none was left to him remaining.* So the LORD our God gave into our hands Og also, the king of Bashan, and all his people. We struck him down until He had no survivor left.
- 4 *And we took all his cities at that time, there was not a city which we took not from them, threescore cities, all the region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan.* we took all His cities at that time—there was not a city that we did not take from them—sixty cities, the whole region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan.
- 5 *All these cities were fenced with high walls, gates, and bars; beside unwall'd towns a great many.* All these were cities fortified with high walls, gates, and bars, besides very many unwall'd villages.
- 6 *And we utterly destroyed them, as we did unto Sihon king of Heshbon, utterly destroying the men, women, and children, of every city.* we devoted them to destruction, as we did to Sihon the king of Heshbon, devoting to destruction every city—men, women, and children.
- 7 *But all the cattle, and the spoil of the cities, we took for a prey to ourselves.* But all the livestock and the spoil of the cities we took as our plunder.
- 8 *And we took at that time out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorites the land that was on this side Jordan, from the river of Arnon unto mount Hermon;* So we took the land at that time out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, from the Valley of the Arnon to Mount Hermon
- 9 *(Which Hermon the Sidonians call Sirion; and the Amorites call it Shenir;)* (the Sidonians call Hermon Sirion, while the Amorites call it Senir),

- 10 *All the cities of the plain, and all Gilead, and all Bashan, unto Salchah and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan.* all the cities of the tableland and all Gilead and all Bashan, as far as Salecah and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan.
- 11 *For only Og king of Bashan remained of the remnant of giants; behold, his bedstead was a bedstead of iron; is it not in Rabbath of the children of Ammon? nine cubits was the length thereof, and four cubits the breadth of it, after the cubit of a man.* (For only Og the king of Bashan was left of the remnant of the giants. His bed was a bed of iron. Is it not in Rabbah of the people of Ammon? Nine cubits was its length, and four cubits its breadth, according to the common cubit.)
- 12 *And this land, which we possessed at that time, from Aroer, which is by the river Arnon, and half mount Gilead, and the cities thereof, gave I unto the Reubenites and to the Gadites.* When we took possession of this land at that time, I gave to the Reubenites and the Gadites the territory beginning at Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, and half the hill country of Gilead with its cities.
- 13 *And the rest of Gilead, and all Bashan, being the kingdom of Og, gave I unto the half tribe of Manasseh; all the region of Argob, with all Bashan, which was called the land of giants.* The rest of Gilead, and all Bashan, the kingdom of Og, that is, all the region of Argob, I gave to the half-tribe of Manasseh. (All that portion of Bashan is called the land of giants.)
- 14 *Jair the son of Manasseh took all the country of Argob unto the coasts of Geshuri and Maachathi; and called them after his own name, Bashanhavothjair, unto this day.* Jair the son of Manasseh took all the region of Argob, that is, Bashan, as far as the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites, and called the villages after his own name, Havvoth-jair, as it is to this day.)
- 15 *And I gave Gilead unto Machir.* I gave Gilead to Machir.

- 16 *And unto the Reubenites and unto the Gadites I gave from Gilead even unto the river Arnon half the valley, and the border even unto the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon;* To the Reubenites and the Gadites I gave the territory from Gilead as far as the Valley of the Arnon, with the middle of the valley as a border, as far as the river Jabbok, the border of the people of Ammon;
- 17 *The plain also, and Jordan, and the coast thereof, from Chinnereth even unto the sea of the plain, even the salt sea, under Ashdothpishgah eastward.* the Arabah also, with the Jordan as the border, from Chinnereth as far as the Sea of the Arabah, the Salt Sea, under the slopes of Pishgah on the east.
- 18 *And I commanded you at that time, saying, The LORD your God hath given you this land to possess it: ye shall pass over armed before your brethren the children of Israel, all that are meet for the war.* I commanded You at that time, "The LORD Your God has given You this land to possess. All Your men of valor shall cross over armed before Your brothers, the people of Israel.
- 19 *But your wives, and your little ones, and your cattle, (for I know that ye have much cattle,) shall abide in your cities which I have given you;* Only Your wives, Your little ones, and Your livestock—I know that You have much livestock—shall remain in the cities I have given You,
- 20 *Until the LORD have given rest unto your brethren, as well as unto you, and until they also possess the land which the LORD your God hath given them beyond Jordan: and then shall ye return every man unto his possession which I have given you.* until the LORD gives rest to Your brothers, as to You. They also occupy the land that the LORD Your God is giving them beyond the Jordan. Then each of You may return to His possession that I have given You."
- 21 *And I commanded Joshua at that time, saying, Thine eyes have seen all that the LORD your God hath done unto these two kings: so shall the LORD do unto all the kingdoms whither thou passest.* I commanded Joshua at that time, "Your eyes have seen all that the LORD your God has done to these two kings. So will the LORD do to all the kingdoms into which You are about to cross.
- 22 *Ye shall not fear them: for the LORD your God he shall fight for you.* You shall not fear them, for it is the LORD Your God Who fights for You."

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| 23 | <i>And I besought the LORD at that time, saying,</i> | I pleaded with the LORD at that time, saying, |
| 24 | <i>O Lord GOD, thou hast begun to shew thy servant thy greatness, and thy mighty hand: for what God is there in heaven or in earth, that can do according to thy works, and according to thy might?</i> | "O Lord GOD, You have only begun to show Your servant Your greatness and Your mighty hand. For what god is there in heaven or on earth who can do such works and mighty acts as Yours? |
| 25 | <i>I pray thee, let me go over, and see the good land that is beyond Jordan, that goodly mountain, and Lebanon.</i> | Please let me go over and see the good land beyond the Jordan, that good hill country and Lebanon." |
| 26 | <i>But the LORD was wroth with me for your sakes, and would not hear me: and the LORD said unto me, Let it suffice thee; speak no more unto me of this matter.</i> | But the LORD was angry with me because of You and would not listen to me. And the LORD said to me, "Enough from You; do not speak to me of this matter again. |
| 27 | <i>Get thee up into the top of Pisgah, and lift up thine eyes westward, and northward, and southward, and eastward, and behold it with thine eyes: for thou shalt not go over this Jordan.</i> | Go up to the top of Pisgah and lift up Your eyes westward and northward and southward and eastward, and look at it with Your eyes, for You shall not go over this Jordan. |
| 28 | <i>But charge Joshua, and encourage him, and strengthen him: for he shall go over before this people, and he shall cause them to inherit the land which thou shalt see.</i> | But commission Joshua, and encourage and strengthen him, for he shall go over at the head of this people. He shall put them in possession of the land that you shall see." |
| 29 | <i>So we abode in the valley over against Bethpeor.</i> | So we remained in the valley opposite Beth-peor. |

Words in this chapter:

Bashan (BAY-shan) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Jordan (JOR-dan) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v4** — 1 Kgs 4:13
v6 — Deut 2:34
v9 — Ps 29:6; 1 Chr 5:23
v14 — Num 32:41
v17 — Josh 12:3; Gen 14:3
v18 — Num 32:20-24
v22 — Ex 14:14; Deut 20:4; Deut 1:30; Josh 10:42; 2 Chr 20:29
v24 — Ex 15:11; Deut 11:2; Ps 71:19; Ps 86:8; 2 Sam 7:22
v26 — Deut 1:37; Deut 31:2
v27 — Num 27:12
v28 — Deut 31:3
v29 — Deut 34:6; Deut 4:46

Chapter 4

Moses urges Israel to obey the LORD's statutes so they may live and possess the land. He warns them against making graven images and reminds them of what they saw at Horeb -- they heard a voice but saw no form. He establishes three cities of refuge east of the Jordan.

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| <p>¹ <i>Now therefore hearken, O Israel, unto the statutes and unto the judgments, which I teach you, for to do them, that ye may live, and go in and possess the land which the LORD God of your fathers giveth you.</i></p> | <p>Now, O Israel, listen to the statutes and the rules that I am teaching you, and do them, that You may live, and go in and take possession of the land that the LORD, the God of Your fathers, is giving You.</p> |
| <p>² <i>Ye shall not add unto the word which I command you, neither shall ye diminish ought from it, that ye may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you.</i></p> | <p>You shall not add to the word that I command You, nor take from it, that You may keep the commandments of the LORD Your God that I command You.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>Your eyes have seen what the LORD did because of Baalpeor: for all the men that followed Baalpeor, the LORD thy God hath destroyed them from among you.</i></p> | <p>Your eyes have seen what the LORD did at Baal-peor, for the LORD Your God destroyed from among You all the men who followed the Baal of Peor.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>But ye that did cleave unto the LORD your God are alive every one of you this day.</i></p> | <p>But You who held fast to the LORD Your God are all alive today.</p> |

- 5 *Behold, I have taught you statutes and judgments, even as the LORD my God commanded me, that ye should do so in the land whither ye go to possess it.* See, I have taught You statutes and rules, as the LORD my God commanded me, that You should do them in the land that You are entering to take possession of it.
- 6 *Keep therefore and do them; for this is your wisdom and your understanding in the sight of the nations, which shall hear all these statutes, and say, Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people.* Keep them and do them, for that will be Your wisdom and Your understanding in the sight of the peoples, who, when they hear all these statutes, will say, "Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people."
- 7 *For what nation is there so great, who hath God so nigh unto them, as the LORD our God is in all things that we call upon him for?* For what great nation is there that has a god so near to it as the LORD our God is to us, whenever we call upon Him?
- 8 *And what nation is there so great, that hath statutes and judgments so righteous as all this law, which I set before you this day?* what great nation is there that has statutes and rules so righteous as all this law that I set before You today?
- 9 *Only take heed to thyself, and keep thy soul diligently, lest thou forget the things which thine eyes have seen, and lest they depart from thy heart all the days of thy life: but teach them thy sons, and thy sons' sons;* Only take care, and keep Your soul diligently, lest You forget the things that Your eyes have seen, and lest they depart from Your heart all the days of Your life. Make them known to Your children and Your children's children—
- 10 *Specially the day that thou stoodest before the LORD thy God in Horeb, when the LORD said unto me, Gather me the people together, and I will make them hear my words, that they may learn to fear me all the days that they shall live upon the earth, and that they may teach their children.* especially the day You stood before the LORD Your God at Horeb, when the LORD said to me, "Gather the people to me, that I may let them hear my words, so that they may learn to fear me all the days that they live on the earth, and that they may teach their children so."

- 11 *And ye came near and stood under the mountain; and the mountain burned with fire unto the midst of heaven, with darkness, clouds, and thick darkness.* you came near and stood at the foot of the mountain, while the mountain burned with fire to the heart of heaven, wrapped in darkness, cloud, and deep gloom.
- 12 *And the LORD spake unto you out of the midst of the fire: ye heard the voice of the words, but saw no similitude; only ye heard a voice.* Then the LORD spoke to You out of the midst of the fire. You heard the sound of words, but saw no form; there was only a voice.
- 13 *And he declared unto you his covenant, which he commanded you to perform, even ten commandments; and he wrote them upon two tables of stone.* he declared to You His covenant, which He commanded You to perform, that is, the Ten Commandments. He wrote them on two tablets of stone.
- 14 *And the LORD commanded me at that time to teach you statutes and judgments, that ye might do them in the land whither ye go over to possess it.* the LORD commanded me at that time to teach You statutes and rules, that You might do them in the land that You are going over to possess.
- 15 *Take ye therefore good heed unto yourselves; for ye saw no manner of similitude on the day that the LORD spake unto you in Horeb out of the midst of the fire:* Therefore watch yourselves very carefully. Since You saw no form on the day that the LORD spoke to You at Horeb out of the midst of the fire,
- 16 *Lest ye corrupt yourselves, and make you a graven image, the similitude of any figure, the likeness of male or female,* beware lest You act corruptly by making a carved image for yourselves, in the form of any figure, the likeness of male or female,
- 17 *The likeness of any beast that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged fowl that flieth in the air,* the likeness of any animal that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged bird that flies in the air,
- 18 *The likeness of any thing that creepeth on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the waters beneath the earth:* the likeness of anything that creeps on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the water under the earth.

- 19 *And lest thou lift up thine eyes unto heaven, and when thou seest the sun, and the moon, and the stars, even all the host of heaven, shouldest be driven to worship them, and serve them, which the LORD thy God hath divided unto all nations under the whole heaven.* beware lest You raise Your eyes to heaven, and when You see the sun and the moon and the stars, all the host of heaven, You be drawn away and bow down to them and serve them, things that the LORD Your God has allotted to all the peoples under the whole heaven.
- 20 *But the LORD hath taken you, and brought you forth out of the iron furnace, even out of Egypt, to be unto him a people of inheritance, as ye are this day.* But the LORD has taken You and brought You out of the iron furnace, out of Egypt, to be a people of His own inheritance, as You are this day.
- 21 *Furthermore the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, and sware that I should not go over Jordan, and that I should not go in unto that good land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance:* Furthermore, the LORD was angry with me because of You. He swore that I should not cross the Jordan, and that I should not enter the good land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance.
- 22 *But I must die in this land, I must not go over Jordan: but ye shall go over, and possess that good land.* For I must die in this land; I must not go over the Jordan. But You shall go over and take possession of that good land.
- 23 *Take heed unto yourselves, lest ye forget the covenant of the LORD your God, which he made with you, and make you a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, which the LORD thy God hath forbidden thee.* Take care, lest You forget the covenant of the LORD Your God, which He made with You, and make a carved image, the form of anything that the LORD Your God has forbidden You.
- 24 *For the LORD thy God is a consuming fire, even a jealous God.* For the LORD Your God is a consuming fire, a jealous God.

- 25 *When thou shalt beget children, and children's children, and ye shall have remained long in the land, and shall corrupt yourselves, and make a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, and shall do evil in the sight of the LORD thy God, to provoke him to anger:* When You father children and children's children, and have grown old in the land, if You act corruptly by making a carved image in the form of anything, and by doing what is evil in the sight of the LORD Your God, provoking Him to anger,
- 26 *I call heaven and earth to witness against you this day, that ye shall soon utterly perish from off the land whereunto ye go over Jordan to possess it; ye shall not prolong your days upon it, but shall utterly be destroyed.* I call heaven and earth to witness against You today, that You will soon utterly perish from the land that You are going over the Jordan to possess. You will not live long in it, but will be utterly destroyed.
- 27 *And the LORD shall scatter you among the nations, and ye shall be left few in number among the heathen, whither the LORD shall lead you.* the LORD will scatter You among the peoples, and You will be left few in number among the nations where the LORD will drive You.
- 28 *And there ye shall serve gods, the work of men's hands, wood and stone, which neither see, nor hear, nor eat, nor smell.* there You will serve gods of wood and stone, the work of human hands, that neither see, nor hear, nor eat, nor smell.
- 29 *But if from thence thou shalt seek the LORD thy God, thou shalt find him, if thou seek him with all thy heart and with all thy soul.* But from there You will seek the LORD Your God and You will find Him, if You search after Him with all Your heart and with all Your soul.
- 30 *When thou art in tribulation, and all these things are come upon thee, even in the latter days, if thou turn to the LORD thy God, and shalt be obedient unto his voice;* When You are in tribulation, and all these things come upon You in the latter days, You will return to the LORD Your God and obey His voice.

- 31 *(For the LORD thy God is a merciful God;) he will not forsake thee, neither destroy thee, nor forget the covenant of thy fathers which he sware unto them.* For the LORD Your God is a merciful God. He will not leave You or destroy You or forget the covenant with Your fathers that He swore to them.
- 32 *For ask now of the days that are past, which were before thee, since the day that God created man upon the earth, and ask from the one side of heaven unto the other, whether there hath been any such thing as this great thing is, or hath been heard like it?* For ask now of the days that are past, from the day God created man on the earth, and ask from one end of heaven to the other, whether such a great thing as this has ever happened or was ever heard of.
- 33 *Did ever people hear the voice of God speaking out of the midst of the fire, as thou hast heard, and live?* Did any people ever hear the voice of a god speaking out of the midst of the fire, as You have heard, and still live?
- 34 *Or hath God assayed to go and take him a nation from the midst of another nation, by temptations, by signs, and by wonders, and by war, and by a mighty hand, and by a stretched out arm, and by great terrors, according to all that the LORD your God did for you in Egypt before your eyes?* Or has any god ever attempted to go and take a nation for Himself from the midst of another nation, by trials, by signs, by wonders, by war, by a mighty hand and an outstretched arm, and by great deeds of terror, all of which the LORD Your God did for You in Egypt before Your eyes?
- 35 *Unto thee it was shewed, that thou mightest know that the LORD he is God; there is none else beside him.* To You it was shown, that You might know that the LORD is God; there is no other besides Him.
- 36 *Out of heaven he made thee to hear his voice, that he might instruct thee: and upon earth he shewed thee his great fire; and thou heardest his words out of the midst of the fire.* Out of heaven He let You hear His voice, that He might discipline You. And on earth He let You see His great fire, and You heard His words out of the midst of the fire.
- 37 *And because he loved thy fathers, therefore he chose their seed after them, and brought thee out in his sight with his mighty power out of Egypt;* because He loved Your fathers and chose their seed after them and brought You out of Egypt with His own presence, by His great power,

- 38 *To drive out nations from before thee greater and mightier than thou art, to bring thee in, to give thee their land for an inheritance, as it is this day.* driving out before You nations greater and mightier than you, to bring you in, to give you their land for an inheritance, as it is this day,
- 39 *Know therefore this day, and consider it in thine heart, that the LORD he is God in heaven above, and upon the earth beneath: there is none else.* know therefore today, and lay it to Your heart, that the LORD is God in heaven above and on the earth beneath; there is no other.
- 40 *Thou shalt keep therefore his statutes, and his commandments, which I command thee this day, that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee, and that thou mayest prolong thy days upon the earth, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, for ever.* Therefore You shall keep His statutes and His commandments, which I command You today, that it may go well with You and with Your children after You, and that You may prolong Your days in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You for all time.
- 41 *Then Moses severed three cities on this side Jordan toward the sunrising;* Then Moses set apart three cities in the east beyond the Jordan,
- 42 *That the slayer might flee thither, which should kill his neighbour unawares, and hated him not in times past; and that fleeing unto one of these cities he might live:* that the manslayer might flee there, anyone who kills his neighbor unintentionally, without having hated him in the past; he could flee to one of these cities and live:
- 43 *Namely, Bezer in the wilderness, in the plain country, of the Reubenites; and Ramoth in Gilead, of the Gadites; and Golan in Bashan, of the Manassites.* Bezer in the wilderness on the tableland for the Reubenites, Ramoth in Gilead for the Gadites, and Golan in Bashan for the Manassites.
- 44 *And this is the law which Moses set before the children of Israel:* This is the law that Moses set before the people of Israel.
- 45 *These are the testimonies, and the statutes, and the judgments, which Moses spake unto the children of Israel, after they came forth out of Egypt,* These are the testimonies, the statutes, and the rules, which Moses spoke to the people of Israel when they came out of Egypt,

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| <p>46 <i>On this side Jordan, in the valley over against Bethpeor, in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who dwelt at Heshbon, whom Moses and the children of Israel smote, after they were come forth out of Egypt:</i></p> <p>47 <i>And they possessed his land, and the land of Og king of Bashan, two kings of the Amorites, which were on this side Jordan toward the sunrising;</i></p> <p>48 <i>From Aroer, which is by the bank of the river Arnon, even unto mount Sion, which is Hermon,</i></p> <p>49 <i>And all the plain on this side Jordan eastward, even unto the sea of the plain, under the springs of Pishgah.</i></p> | <p>beyond the Jordan in the valley opposite Beth-peor, in the land of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon, whom Moses and the people of Israel defeated when they came out of Egypt.</p> <p>they took possession of his land and the land of Og, the king of Bashan, the two kings of the Amorites, who lived to the east beyond the Jordan;</p> <p>from Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, as far as mount Sion, which is Hermon,</p> <p>together with all the Arabah on the east side of the Jordan as far as the Sea of the Arabah, under the slopes of Pishgah.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Horeb (*HOR-eb*) — Another name for Mount Sinai — the mountain where God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and later where Elijah fled from Jezebel.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Prov 30:6; Deut 12:32; Rev 22:18-19; Josh 1:7; Matt 5:18
- v7 — Ps 145:18; 2 Sam 7:23; Ps 34:18; Jas 4:8; Ps 73:28
- v9 — Deut 6:7; Deut 11:19; Ps 78:3-8; Gen 18:19; Deut 32:46
- v13 — Ex 34:28; Ex 31:18; Ex 24:12; Deut 9:9-11; Ex 19:5
- v19 — Rom 1:25; Deut 17:3; 2 Kgs 21:3; Gen 1:16-18; 2 Kgs 17:16
- v24 — Heb 12:29; Nah 1:6; Deut 9:3; Ex 24:17; Isa 33:14
- v26 — Deut 32:1; Mic 6:2; Jer 22:29; Deut 30:18-19; Jer 2:12
- v29 — Ps 119:2; Jer 29:12-14; 2 Chr 15:4; Ps 119:10; Isa 55:6-7
- v31 — Deut 31:8; Ps 116:5; Neh 9:31; Jonah 4:2; Ex 34:6-7
- v34 — Deut 26:8; Deut 5:15; Ex 6:6; Deut 7:19; Deut 7:8-9
- v35 — Isa 45:18; 1 Sam 2:2; Isa 45:5; Isa 44:8; Deut 4:39
- v39 — Josh 2:11; Deut 4:35; 1 Chr 29:11; Hos 7:2; Ps 135:6

Chapter 5

Moses restates the Ten Commandments given at Horeb. He reminds the people that the LORD spoke to them face to face out of the fire, and that they were so afraid they asked Moses to be their mediator with God.

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| <p>1 <i>And Moses called all Israel, and said unto them, Hear, O Israel, the statutes and judgments which I speak in your ears this day, that ye may learn them, and keep, and do them.</i></p> <p>2 <i>The LORD our God made a covenant with us in Horeb.</i></p> <p>3 <i>The LORD made not this covenant with our fathers, but with us, even us, who are all of us here alive this day.</i></p> <p>4 <i>The LORD talked with you face to face in the mount out of the midst of the fire,</i></p> <p>5 <i>(I stood between the LORD and you at that time, to shew you the word of the LORD: for ye were afraid by reason of the fire, and went not up into the mount;) saying,</i></p> <p>6 <i>I am the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Thou shalt have none other gods before me.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Thou shalt not make thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the waters beneath the earth:</i></p> | <p>Moses summoned all Israel and said to them, "Hear, O Israel, the statutes and the rules that I speak in your hearing today, and you shall learn them and be careful to do them.</p> <p>The LORD our God made a covenant with us in Horeb.</p> <p>Not with our fathers did the LORD make this covenant, but with us, who are all of us here alive today.</p> <p>The LORD spoke with You face to face at the mountain, out of the midst of the fire,</p> <p>while I stood between the LORD and You at that time, to declare to You the word of the LORD. For You were afraid because of the fire, and You did not go up into the mountain. He said:</p> <p>"I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery.</p> <p>You shall have no other gods before me.</p> <p>You shall not make for Yourself a carved image, or any likeness of anything that is in heaven above, or that is on the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth.</p> |
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- 9 *Thou shalt not bow down thyself unto them, nor serve them: for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me,* You shall not bow down to them or serve them; for I the LORD Your God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children to the third and fourth generation of those who hate me,
- 10 *And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me and keep my commandments.* but showing mercy to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments.
- 11 *Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain: for the LORD thy God will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.* You shall not take the name of the LORD Your God in vain, for the LORD Your God will not hold Him guiltless who takes His name in vain.
- 12 *Keep the sabbath day to sanctify it, as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee.* Observe the Sabbath day, to keep it holy, as the LORD Your God commanded You.
- 13 *Six days thou shalt labour, and do all thy work:* Six days You shall labor and do all Your work,
- 14 *But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thine ox, nor thine ass, nor any of thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates; that thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest as well as thou.* but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD Your God. On it You shall not do any work, You or Your son or Your daughter or Your male servant or Your female servant, or Your ox or Your donkey or any of Your livestock, or the foreigner who is within Your gates, that Your male servant and Your female servant may rest as well as You.
- 15 *And remember that thou wast a servant in the land of Egypt, and that the LORD thy God brought thee out thence through a mighty hand and by a stretched out arm: therefore the LORD thy God commanded thee to keep the sabbath day.* You shall remember that You were a slave in the land of Egypt. The LORD Your God brought You out from there with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm. Therefore the LORD Your God commanded You to keep the Sabbath day.

- 16 *Honour thy father and thy mother, as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee; that thy days may be prolonged, and that it may go well with thee, in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.* Honor Your father and Your mother, as the LORD Your God commanded You, that Your days may be long, and that it may go well with You in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You.
- 17 *Thou shalt not kill.* You shall not kill.
- 18 *Neither shalt thou commit adultery.* you shall not commit adultery.
- 19 *Neither shalt thou steal.* you shall not steal.
- 20 *Neither shalt thou bear false witness against thy neighbour.* you shall not bear false witness against Your neighbor.
- 21 *Neither shalt thou desire thy neighbour's wife, neither shalt thou covet thy neighbour's house, his field, or his manservant, or his maidservant, his ox, or his ass, or any thing that is thy neighbour's.* you shall not covet Your neighbor's wife. And You shall not desire Your neighbor's house, His field, or His male servant, or His female servant, His ox, or his donkey, or anything that is Your neighbor's.
- 22 *These words the LORD spake unto all your assembly in the mount out of the midst of the fire, of the cloud, and of the thick darkness, with a great voice: and he added no more. And he wrote them in two tables of stone, and delivered them unto me.* These words the LORD spoke to all Your assembly at the mountain out of the midst of the fire, the cloud, and the thick darkness, with a loud voice. He added no more. And He wrote them on two tablets of stone and gave them to me.
- 23 *And it came to pass, when ye heard the voice out of the midst of the darkness, (for the mountain did burn with fire,) that ye came near unto me, even all the heads of your tribes, and your elders;* as soon as You heard the voice out of the midst of the darkness, while the mountain was burning with fire, You came near to me, all the heads of Your tribes, and Your elders.

- 24 *And ye said, Behold, the LORD our God hath shewed us his glory and his greatness, and we have heard his voice out of the midst of the fire: we have seen this day that God doth talk with man, and he liveth.* you said, "The LORD our God has shown us His glory and greatness. We have heard His voice out of the midst of the fire. This day we have seen God speak with man, and man still live.
- 25 *Now therefore why should we die? for this great fire will consume us: if we hear the voice of the LORD our God any more, then we shall die.* Now therefore why should we die? For this great fire will consume us. If we hear the voice of the LORD our God any more, we shall die.
- 26 *For who is there of all flesh, that hath heard the voice of the living God speaking out of the midst of the fire, as we have, and lived?* For who is there of all flesh, that has heard the voice of the living God speaking out of the midst of fire as we have, and has still lived?
- 27 *Go thou near, and hear all that the LORD our God shall say: and speak thou unto us all that the LORD our God shall speak unto thee; and we will hear it, and do it.* Go near and hear all that the LORD our God will say, and speak to us all that the LORD our God will speak to You. We will hear and do it."
- 28 *And the LORD heard the voice of your words, when ye spake unto me; and the LORD said unto me, I have heard the voice of the words of this people, which they have spoken unto thee: they have well said all that they have spoken.* the LORD heard Your words, when You spoke to me. And the LORD said to me, "I have heard the words of this people, which they have spoken to You. They are right in all that they have spoken.
- 29 *O that there were such an heart in them, that they would fear me, and keep all my commandments always, that it might be well with them, and with their children for ever!* Oh that they had such a heart as this always, to fear me and to keep all my commandments, that it might go well with them and with their descendants forever!
- 30 *Go say to them, Get you into your tents again.* Go and say to them, "Return to Your tents."

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| <p>31 <i>But as for thee, stand thou here by me, and I will speak unto thee all the commandments, and the statutes, and the judgments, which thou shalt teach them, that they may do them in the land which I give them to possess it.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Ye shall observe to do therefore as the LORD your God hath commanded you: ye shall not turn aside to the right hand or to the left.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Ye shall walk in all the ways which the LORD your God hath commanded you, that ye may live, and that it may be well with you, and that ye may prolong your days in the land which ye shall possess.</i></p> | <p>But You, stand here by me. I will tell You the whole commandment and the statutes and the rules that You shall teach them, that they may do them in the land that I am giving them to possess."</p> <p>You shall be careful therefore to do as the LORD Your God has commanded You. You shall not turn aside to the right hand or to the left.</p> <p>You shall walk in all the way that the LORD Your God has commanded You, that You may live, and that it may go well with You, and that You may live long in the land that You shall possess.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v6** — Ex 20:2-17; Ps 81:5-10
v9 — Ex 20:4-6; Ex 34:7; Dan 9:4-9; Num 14:18; Ex 34:14
v10 — Rom 8:28; 1 John 1:7; Jer 32:18; John 15:14; Deut 6:5-6
v11 — Ex 20:7; Deut 6:13; Lev 19:12
v12 — Ex 20:8-11; Isa 58:13
v16 — Ex 20:12; Eph 6:1-3; Col 3:20; Deut 27:16; Deut 4:40
v17 — Ex 20:13; Rom 13:9
v19 — Ex 20:15; Rom 13:9
v20 — Ex 20:16; Ex 23:1
v21 — Ex 20:17; Rom 13:9
v29 — Isa 48:18; Ezek 33:31-32; Deut 11:1; Matt 23:37; Luke 19:42
v33 — Jer 7:23; Deut 4:40; Luke 1:6; Deut 10:12; 1 Tim 4:8

Chapter 6

Moses commands Israel to love the LORD their God with all their heart, soul, and might, and to teach these words diligently to their children. He warns them not to forget the LORD when

they enter the Promised Land and enjoy its abundance.

- 1 *Now these are the commandments, the statutes, and the judgments, which the LORD your God commanded to teach you, that ye might do them in the land whither ye go to possess it:* Now these are the commandments, the statutes, and the rules that the LORD Your God commanded me to teach You, that You may do them in the land to which You are going over to possess it,
- 2 *That thou mightest fear the LORD thy God, to keep all his statutes and his commandments, which I command thee, thou, and thy son, and thy son's son, all the days of thy life; and that thy days may be prolonged.* so that You may fear the LORD Your God, You and Your son and Your son's son, by keeping all His statutes and His commandments that I command You, all the days of Your life, and that Your days may be long.
- 3 *Hear therefore, O Israel, and observe to do it; that it may be well with thee, and that ye may increase mightily, as the LORD God of thy fathers hath promised thee, in the land that floweth with milk and honey.* Hear therefore, O Israel, and be careful to do them, that it may go well with you, and that you may multiply greatly, as the LORD, the God of Your fathers, has promised You, in a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 4 *Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD:* Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is one.
- 5 *And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might.* You shall love the LORD Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul and with all Your might.
- 6 *And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart:* these words that I command You today shall be on Your heart.
- 7 *And thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.* You shall teach them diligently to Your children, and shall talk of them when You sit in Your house, and when You walk by the way, and when You lie down, and when You rise.
- 8 *And thou shalt bind them for a sign upon thine hand, and they shall be as frontlets between thine eyes.* You shall bind them as a sign on Your hand. They shall be as frontlets between Your eyes.

- 9 *And thou shalt write them upon the posts of thy house, and on thy gates.* You shall write them on the doorposts of Your house and on Your gates.
- 10 *And it shall be, when the LORD thy God shall have brought thee into the land which he swore unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give thee great and goodly cities, which thou buildedst not,* when the LORD Your God brings You into the land that He swore to Your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give you—with great and good cities that You did not build,
- 11 *And houses full of all good things, which thou filledst not, and wells digged, which thou diggedst not, vineyards and olive trees, which thou plantedst not; when thou shalt have eaten and be full;* houses full of all good things that You did not fill, and cisterns that You did not dig, and vineyards and olive trees that You did not plant—and when You eat and are full,
- 12 *Then beware lest thou forget the LORD, which brought thee forth out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.* then take care lest You forget the LORD, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery.
- 13 *Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God, and serve him, and shalt swear by his name.* It is the LORD Your God You shall fear. Him You shall serve and by His name You shall swear.
- 14 *Ye shall not go after other gods, of the gods of the people which are round about you;* You shall not go after other gods, the gods of the peoples who are around You—
- 15 *(For the LORD thy God is a jealous God among you) lest the anger of the LORD thy God be kindled against thee, and destroy thee from off the face of the earth.* for the LORD Your God in Your midst is a jealous God—lest the anger of the LORD Your God be kindled against You, and destroy You from off the face of the earth.
- 16 *Ye shall not tempt the LORD your God, as ye tempted him in Massah.* You shall not put the LORD Your God to the test, as You tested Him at Massah.

- 17 *Ye shall diligently keep the commandments of the LORD your God, and his testimonies, and his statutes, which he hath commanded thee.* You shall diligently keep the commandments of the LORD Your God, and His testimonies and His statutes which He has commanded You.
- 18 *And thou shalt do that which is right and good in the sight of the LORD: that it may be well with thee, and that thou mayest go in and possess the good land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers,* you shall do what is right and good in the sight of the LORD, that it may go well with You, and that You may go in and take possession of the good land that the LORD swore to give to Your fathers
- 19 *To cast out all thine enemies from before thee, as the LORD hath spoken.* by driving out all Your enemies from before You, as the LORD has promised.
- 20 *And when thy son asketh thee in time to come, saying, What mean the testimonies, and the statutes, and the judgments, which the LORD our God hath commanded you?* When Your son asks You in time to come, "What is the meaning of the testimonies and the statutes and the rules that the LORD our God has commanded You?"
- 21 *Then thou shalt say unto thy son, We were Pharaoh's bondmen in Egypt; and the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand:* then You shall say to Your son, "We were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt. And the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand.
- 22 *And the LORD shewed signs and wonders, great and sore, upon Egypt, upon Pharaoh, and upon all his household, before our eyes:* the LORD showed signs and wonders, great and grievous, against Egypt and against Pharaoh and all his household, before our eyes.
- 23 *And he brought us out from thence, that he might bring us in, to give us the land which he sware unto our fathers.* he brought us out from there, that He might bring us in and give us the land that He swore to give to our fathers.

- 24 *And the LORD commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear the LORD our God, for our good always, that he might preserve us alive, as it is at this day.* the LORD commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear the LORD our God, for our good always, that He might preserve us alive, as we are this day.
- 25 *And it shall be our righteousness, if we observe to do all these commandments before the LORD our God, as he hath commanded us.* it will be righteousness for us, if we are careful to do all this commandment before the LORD our God, as He has commanded us."

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Deut 4:1; Deut 12:1; Deut 4:45; Deut 5:31; Lev 27:34
v2 — Deut 4:40; Ex 20:20; Eccl 12:13; Deut 13:4; Ps 128:1
v4 — Mark 12:29-32; Isa 44:6; 1 Tim 2:5; Isa 45:5-6; John 17:3
v5 — Mark 12:30; Matt 22:37; Luke 10:27; Deut 10:12; Deut 30:6
v6 — Col 3:16; Prov 7:3; Jer 31:33; Deut 11:18; 2 Cor 3:3
v7 — Deut 11:19; Eph 6:4; Ps 78:4-6; 1 Pet 3:15; Deut 4:9-10
v8 — Prov 6:21; Deut 11:18; Prov 3:3; Prov 7:3; Ex 13:9
v10 — Josh 24:13; Ps 105:44; Neh 9:25; Gen 26:3; Ps 78:55
v11 — Deut 7:12-18; Deut 8:10-20; Ezek 16:10-20; Jer 2:31-32; Prov 30:8-9
v13 — Luke 4:8; Deut 10:20; Matt 4:10; Deut 13:4; Lev 19:12
v16 — Ex 17:7; Luke 4:12; Matt 4:7; Ps 95:8-9; Heb 3:8-9
v17 — Deut 11:22; Ps 119:4; 2 Pet 3:14; 2 Pet 1:5-10; 1 Cor 15:58

Chapter 7

Moses commands Israel to utterly destroy the seven nations of Canaan when they enter the land, making no covenants and no marriages with them. He assures them that the LORD has chosen Israel not because they are great in number but because He loves them and keeps His covenant.

- 1 *When the LORD thy God shall bring thee into the land whither thou goest to possess it, and hath cast out many nations before thee, the Hittites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, seven nations greater and mightier than thou;* When the LORD Your God brings You into the land that You are entering to take possession of it, and clears away many nations before You—the Hittites, the Girgashites, the Amorites, the Canaanites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, seven nations more numerous and mightier than You—
- 2 *And when the LORD thy God shall deliver them before thee; thou shalt smite them, and utterly destroy them; thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor shew mercy unto them:* when the LORD Your God gives them over to You, and You defeat them, then You must devote them to complete destruction. You shall make no covenant with them and show them no mercy.
- 3 *Neither shalt thou make marriages with them; thy daughter thou shalt not give unto his son, nor his daughter shalt thou take unto thy son.* You shall not intermarry with them, giving Your daughters to their sons or taking their daughters for Your sons,
- 4 *For they will turn away thy son from following me, that they may serve other gods: so will the anger of the LORD be kindled against you, and destroy thee suddenly.* for they would turn away Your sons from following me, to serve other gods. Then the anger of the LORD would be kindled against You. He would destroy You quickly.
- 5 *But thus shall ye deal with them; ye shall destroy their altars, and break down their images, and cut down their groves, and burn their graven images with fire.* But thus shall You deal with them: You shall break down their altars and dash in pieces their pillars and chop down their groves and burn their carved images with fire.
- 6 *For thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God: the LORD thy God hath chosen thee to be a special people unto himself, above all people that are upon the face of the earth.* For You are a people holy to the LORD Your God. The LORD Your God has chosen You to be a people for His treasured possession, out of all the peoples who are on the face of the earth.

- 7 *The LORD did not set his love upon you, nor choose you, because ye were more in number than any people; for ye were the fewest of all people:* It was not because You were more in number than any other people that the LORD set His love on You and chose You, for You were the fewest of all peoples,
- 8 *But because the LORD loved you, and because he would keep the oath which he had sworn unto your fathers, hath the LORD brought you out with a mighty hand, and redeemed you out of the house of bondmen, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt.* but it is because the LORD loves You and is keeping the oath that He swore to Your fathers, that the LORD has brought You out with a mighty hand and redeemed You from the house of slavery, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt.
- 9 *Know therefore that the LORD thy God, he is God, the faithful God, which keepeth covenant and mercy with them that love him and keep his commandments to a thousand generations;* Know therefore that the LORD Your God is God, the faithful God Who keeps covenant and mercy with those who love Him and keep His commandments, to a thousand generations,
- 10 *And repayeth them that hate him to their face, to destroy them: he will not be slack to him that hateth him, he will repay him to his face.* repays to their face those who hate Him, by destroying them. He will not be slack with one who hates Him. He will repay Him to His face.
- 11 *Thou shalt therefore keep the commandments, and the statutes, and the judgments, which I command thee this day, to do them.* You shall therefore be careful to do the commandment and the statutes and the rules that I command You today.
- 12 *Wherefore it shall come to pass, if ye hearken to these judgments, and keep, and do them, that the LORD thy God shall keep unto thee the covenant and the mercy which he sware unto thy fathers:* because You listen to these rules and keep and do them, the LORD Your God will keep with You the covenant and the mercy that He swore to Your fathers.

- 13 *And he will love thee, and bless thee, and multiply thee: he will also bless the fruit of thy womb, and the fruit of thy land, thy corn, and thy wine, and thine oil, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep, in the land which he swore unto thy fathers to give thee.* He will love You, bless You, and multiply You. He will also bless the fruit of Your womb and the fruit of Your ground, Your grain and Your wine and Your oil, the increase of Your herds and the young of Your flock, in the land that He swore to Your fathers to give You.
- 14 *Thou shalt be blessed above all people: there shall not be male or female barren among you, or among your cattle.* You shall be blessed above all peoples. There shall not be male or female barren among You or among Your livestock.
- 15 *And the LORD will take away from thee all sickness, and will put none of the evil diseases of Egypt, which thou knowest, upon thee; but will lay them upon all them that hate thee.* the LORD will take away from You all sickness, and none of the evil diseases of Egypt, which You knew, will He inflict on You. But He will lay them on all who hate You.
- 16 *And thou shalt consume all the people which the LORD thy God shall deliver thee; thine eye shall have no pity upon them: neither shalt thou serve their gods; for that will be a snare unto thee.* you shall consume all the peoples that the LORD Your God will give over to You. Your eye shall not pity them, neither shall You serve their gods, for that would be a snare to You.
- 17 *If thou shalt say in thine heart, These nations are more than I; how can I dispossess them?* If You say in Your heart, "These nations are greater than I. How can I dispossess them?"
- 18 *Thou shalt not be afraid of them: but shalt well remember what the LORD thy God did unto Pharaoh, and unto all Egypt;* you shall not be afraid of them but You shall remember what the LORD Your God did to Pharaoh and to all Egypt,

- 19 *The great temptations which thine eyes saw, and the signs, and the wonders, and the mighty hand, and the stretched out arm, whereby the LORD thy God brought thee out: so shall the LORD thy God do unto all the people of whom thou art afraid.* the great trials that Your eyes saw, the signs, the wonders, the mighty hand, and the outstretched arm, by which the LORD Your God brought You out. So will the LORD Your God do to all the peoples of whom You are afraid.
- 20 *Moreover the LORD thy God will send the hornet among them, until they that are left, and hide themselves from thee, be destroyed.* Moreover, the LORD Your God will send the hornet among them, until those who are left and hide themselves from You are destroyed.
- 21 *Thou shalt not be affrighted at them: for the LORD thy God is among you, a mighty God and terrible.* You shall not be in dread of them, for the LORD Your God is in Your midst, a great and awesome God.
- 22 *And the LORD thy God will put out those nations before thee by little and little: thou mayest not consume them at once, lest the beasts of the field increase upon thee.* The LORD Your God will clear away these nations before You little by little. You may not make an end of them at once, lest the wild beasts grow too numerous for You.
- 23 *But the LORD thy God shall deliver them unto thee, and shall destroy them with a mighty destruction, until they be destroyed.* But the LORD Your God will give them over to You and throw them into great confusion, until they are destroyed.
- 24 *And he shall deliver their kings into thine hand, and thou shalt destroy their name from under heaven: there shall no man be able to stand before thee, until thou have destroyed them.* he will give their kings into Your hand, and You shall make their name perish from under heaven. No one shall be able to stand against you until you have destroyed them.
- 25 *The graven images of their gods shall ye burn with fire: thou shalt not desire the silver or gold that is on them, nor take it unto thee, lest thou be snared therein: for it is an abomination to the LORD thy God.* The carved images of their gods You shall burn with fire. You shall not covet the silver or the gold that is on them or take it for yourselves, lest You be ensnared by it, for it is an abomination to the LORD Your God.

- 26 *Neither shalt thou bring an abomination into thine house, lest thou be a cursed thing like it: but thou shalt utterly detest it, and thou shalt utterly abhor it; for it is a cursed thing.* you shall not bring an abominable thing into Your house and become devoted to destruction like it. You shall utterly detest and abhor it, for it is devoted to destruction.

Words in this chapter:

Girgashites (*GER-gah-shytes*) — One of the seven Canaanite nations — listed among the peoples that Israel displaced; little else is known about them beyond their name.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 31:3; Acts 13:19; Deut 4:38; Ex 33:2; Deut 9:1
- v3 — 1 Kgs 11:2; Josh 23:12-13; 2 Cor 6:14-17; Ex 34:15-16; Neh 13:23-27
- v6 — Deut 14:2; Ex 19:5-6; 1 Pet 2:9; Mal 3:17; 1 Cor 6:19-20
- v8 — Ex 20:2; Ex 32:13; Jer 31:3; Eph 2:4-5; Isa 43:4
- v9 — Heb 10:23; 2 Tim 2:13; 2 Thess 3:3; Dan 9:4; 1 Cor 1:9
- v12 — Deut 28:1-14; Deut 7:9; Lev 26:3-13; Ps 105:8-10
- v13 — John 14:21; Deut 28:3-5; John 15:10; Ex 23:25; John 16:27
- v14 — Ex 23:26-33; Deut 28:4; Deut 28:11; Ps 127:3; Lev 26:9
- v15 — Ex 15:26; Ps 105:36-37; Lev 26:3-4; Deut 28:60; Ex 9:11
- v16 — Ex 23:33; Judg 8:27; Deut 19:13; Deut 7:2; Deut 25:12
- v24 — Josh 10:8; Josh 23:9; Josh 1:5; Josh 10:42; Deut 9:14
- v26 — Deut 13:17; Hos 14:8; Ezek 11:18; Rom 2:22; Isa 30:22

Chapter 8

Moses reminds Israel that the LORD humbled them and fed them manna in the wilderness for forty years to teach them that man does not live by bread alone. He warns them not to forget the LORD when they are prosperous in the Promised Land, lest they credit their own power for their wealth.

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| 1 | <i>All the commandments which I command thee this day shall ye observe to do, that ye may live, and multiply, and go in and possess the land which the LORD swore unto your fathers.</i> | The whole commandment that I command You today You shall be careful to do, that You may live and multiply, and go in and possess the land that the LORD swore to give to Your fathers. |
| 2 | <i>And thou shalt remember all the way which the LORD thy God led thee these forty years in the wilderness, to humble thee, and to prove thee, to know what was in thine heart, whether thou wouldest keep his commandments, or no.</i> | you shall remember the whole way that the LORD Your God has led You these forty years in the wilderness, that He might humble You, testing You to know what was in Your heart, whether You would keep His commandments or not. |
| 3 | <i>And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.</i> | he humbled You and let You hunger and fed You with manna, which You did not know, nor did Your fathers know, that He might make You know that man does not live by bread alone, but man lives by every word that comes from the mouth of the LORD. |
| 4 | <i>Thy raiment waxed not old upon thee, neither did thy foot swell, these forty years.</i> | Your clothing did not wear out on You and Your foot did not swell these forty years. |
| 5 | <i>Thou shalt also consider in thine heart, that, as a man chasteneth his son, so the LORD thy God chasteneth thee.</i> | Know then in Your heart that, as a man disciplines his son, the LORD Your God disciplines You. |
| 6 | <i>Therefore thou shalt keep the commandments of the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, and to fear him.</i> | So You shall keep the commandments of the LORD Your God by walking in His ways and by fearing Him. |
| 7 | <i>For the LORD thy God bringeth thee into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of fountains and depths that spring out of valleys and hills;</i> | For the LORD Your God is bringing You into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of fountains and springs, flowing out in the valleys and hills, |

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| 8 | <i>A land of wheat, and barley, and vines, and fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of oil olive, and honey;</i> | a land of wheat and barley, of vines and fig trees and pomegranates, a land of olive trees and honey, |
| 9 | <i>A land wherein thou shalt eat bread without scarceness, thou shalt not lack any thing in it; a land whose stones are iron, and out of whose hills thou mayest dig brass.</i> | a land in which You will eat bread without scarcity, in which You will lack nothing, a land whose stones are iron, and out of whose hills You can dig copper. |
| 10 | <i>When thou hast eaten and art full, then thou shalt bless the LORD thy God for the good land which he hath given thee.</i> | you shall eat and be full, and You shall bless the LORD Your God for the good land He has given You. |
| 11 | <i>Beware that thou forget not the LORD thy God, in not keeping his commandments, and his judgments, and his statutes, which I command thee this day:</i> | Take care lest You forget the LORD Your God by not keeping His commandments and His rules and His statutes, which I command You today, |
| 12 | <i>Lest when thou hast eaten and art full, and hast built goodly houses, and dwelt therein;</i> | lest, when You have eaten and are full and have built good houses and live in them, |
| 13 | <i>And when thy herds and thy flocks multiply, and thy silver and thy gold is multiplied, and all that thou hast is multiplied;</i> | when Your herds and flocks multiply and Your silver and gold is multiplied and all that You have is multiplied, |
| 14 | <i>Then thine heart be lifted up, and thou forget the LORD thy God, which brought thee forth out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage;</i> | then Your heart be lifted up, and You forget the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery, |
| 15 | <i>Who led thee through that great and terrible wilderness, wherein were fiery serpents, and scorpions, and drought, where there was no water; who brought thee forth water out of the rock of flint;</i> | who led You through the great and terrifying wilderness, with its fiery serpents and scorpions and thirsty ground where there was no water, who brought You water out of the flinty rock, |

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| <p>16 <i>Who fed thee in the wilderness with manna, which thy fathers knew not, that he might humble thee, and that he might prove thee, to do thee good at thy latter end;</i></p> <p>17 <i>And thou say in thine heart, My power and the might of mine hand hath gotten me this wealth.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But thou shalt remember the LORD thy God: for it is he that giveth thee power to get wealth, that he may establish his covenant which he sware unto thy fathers, as it is this day.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And it shall be, if thou do at all forget the LORD thy God, and walk after other gods, and serve them, and worship them, I testify against you this day that ye shall surely perish.</i></p> <p>20 <i>As the nations which the LORD destroyeth before your face, so shall ye perish; because ye would not be obedient unto the voice of the LORD your God.</i></p> | <p>who fed You in the wilderness with manna that Your fathers did not know, that He might humble You and test You, to do You good in the end.</p> <p>Beware lest You say in Your heart, "My power and the might of my hand have gotten me this wealth."</p> <p>You shall remember the LORD Your God, for it is He who gives you power to get wealth, that he may confirm His covenant that He swore to Your fathers, as it is this day.</p> <p>if You forget the LORD Your God and go after other gods and serve them and worship them, I solemnly warn You today that You shall surely perish.</p> <p>Like the nations that the LORD makes to perish before You, so shall You perish, because You would not obey the voice of the LORD Your God.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 4:1; Deut 5:32-6:3; 1 Thess 4:1-2; Ps 119:4-6
v2 — Jas 1:3; Deut 8:16; 1 Pet 1:7; Ex 16:4; Deut 2:7
v3 — Matt 4:4; Luke 4:4; Heb 13:5-6; 1 Cor 10:3; Ps 78:23-25
v4 — Neh 9:21; Deut 29:5
v5 — Rev 3:19; 2 Sam 7:14; Job 5:17-18; Prov 3:12; Heb 12:5-11
v6 — Deut 5:33; 1 Sam 12:24; 2 Chr 6:31; Ex 18:20; Ps 128:1
v7 — Deut 11:9-12; Ex 3:8; Ezek 20:6; Ps 65:9-13; Deut 6:10-11
v9 — 1 Chr 22:14; Deut 33:25; Josh 22:8; Job 28:2

v10 — Ps 103:2; Prov 3:9; Rom 14:6; Deut 6:11-12; 1 Tim 4:4-5

v11 — Ps 106:21; Hos 2:8-9; Prov 1:32; Prov 30:9; Ezek 16:10-15

v17 — Deut 9:4; 1 Cor 4:7; Dan 4:30; Isa 10:8-14; Hos 12:8

v18 — Prov 10:22; Hos 2:8; Deut 7:8; Ps 127:1-2; Deut 7:12

Chapter 9

Moses warns Israel not to think their righteousness is why the LORD drives out the nations before them -- it is because of those nations' wickedness. He recounts the golden calf incident at Horeb, reminding them of their repeated rebellions and his forty-day intercession on their behalf.

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| <p>¹ <i>Hear, O Israel: Thou art to pass over Jordan this day, to go in to possess nations greater and mightier than thyself, cities great and fenced up to heaven,</i></p> | <p>Hear, O Israel: you are to cross over the Jordan today, to go in to dispossess nations greater and mightier than You, cities great and fortified up to heaven,</p> |
| <p>² <i>A people great and tall, the children of the Anakims, whom thou knowest, and of whom thou hast heard say, Who can stand before the children of Anak!</i></p> | <p>a people great and tall, the sons of the Anakim, whom You know, and of whom You have heard it said, "Who can stand before the sons of Anak?"</p> |
| <p>³ <i>Understand therefore this day, that the LORD thy God is he which goeth over before thee; as a consuming fire he shall destroy them, and he shall bring them down before thy face: so shalt thou drive them out, and destroy them quickly, as the LORD hath said unto thee.</i></p> | <p>Know therefore today that He who goes over before you as a consuming fire is the LORD Your God. He will destroy them and subdue them before You. So You shall drive them out and make them perish quickly, as the LORD has promised You.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>Speak not thou in thine heart, after that the LORD thy God hath cast them out from before thee, saying, For my righteousness the LORD hath brought me in to possess this land: but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD doth drive them out from before thee.</i></p> | <p>Do not say in Your heart, after the LORD Your God has pushed them back before You, "It is because of my righteousness that the LORD has brought me in to possess this land," whereas it is because of the wickedness of these nations that the LORD is driving them out before You.</p> |

- 5 *Not for thy righteousness, or for the uprightness of thine heart, dost thou go to possess their land: but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD thy God doth drive them out from before thee, and that he may perform the word which the LORD sware unto thy fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.* Not because of Your righteousness or the uprightness of Your heart are You going in to possess their land, but because of the wickedness of these nations the LORD Your God is driving them out from before You, and that He may confirm the word that the LORD swore to Your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.
- 6 *Understand therefore, that the LORD thy God giveth thee not this good land to possess it for thy righteousness; for thou art a stiffnecked people.* Know, therefore, that the LORD Your God is not giving You this good land to possess because of Your righteousness, for You are a stubborn people.
- 7 *Remember, and forget not, how thou provokedst the LORD thy God to wrath in the wilderness: from the day that thou didst depart out of the land of Egypt, until ye came unto this place, ye have been rebellious against the LORD.* Remember and do not forget how You provoked the LORD Your God to wrath in the wilderness. From the day You came out of the land of Egypt until You came to this place, You have been rebellious against the LORD.
- 8 *Also in Horeb ye provoked the LORD to wrath, so that the LORD was angry with you to have destroyed you.* Even at Horeb You provoked the LORD to wrath. The LORD was so angry with You that He was ready to destroy You.
- 9 *When I was gone up into the mount to receive the tables of stone, even the tables of the covenant which the LORD made with you, then I abode in the mount forty days and forty nights, I neither did eat bread nor drink water:* When I went up the mountain to receive the tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant that the LORD made with You, I remained on the mountain forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water.

- 10 *And the LORD delivered unto me two tables of stone written with the finger of God; and on them was written according to all the words, which the LORD spake with you in the mount out of the midst of the fire in the day of the assembly.* the LORD gave me the two tablets of stone written with the finger of God, and on them were all the words that the LORD had spoken with You on the mountain out of the midst of the fire on the day of the assembly.
- 11 *And it came to pass at the end of forty days and forty nights, that the LORD gave me the two tables of stone, even the tables of the covenant.* at the end of forty days and forty nights the LORD gave me the two tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant.
- 12 *And the LORD said unto me, Arise, get thee down quickly from hence; for thy people which thou hast brought forth out of Egypt have corrupted themselves; they are quickly turned aside out of the way which I commanded them; they have made them a molten image.* Then the LORD said to me, "Arise, go down quickly from here, for Your people whom You have brought from Egypt have acted corruptly. They have turned aside quickly out of the way that I commanded them; they have made themselves a metal image."
- 13 *Furthermore the LORD spake unto me, saying, I have seen this people, and, behold, it is a stiffnecked people:* Furthermore the LORD said to me, "I have seen this people. It is a stubborn people.
- 14 *Let me alone, that I may destroy them, and blot out their name from under heaven: and I will make of thee a nation mightier and greater than they.* Let me alone, that I may destroy them and blot out their name from under heaven. And I will make of You a nation mightier and greater than they."
- 15 *So I turned and came down from the mount, and the mount burned with fire: and the two tables of the covenant were in my two hands.* So I turned and came down from the mountain, and the mountain was burning with fire. And the two tablets of the covenant were in my two hands.

- 16 *And I looked, and, behold, ye had sinned against the LORD your God, and had made you a molten calf: ye had turned aside quickly out of the way which the LORD had commanded you.* I looked, and there You had sinned against the LORD Your God. You had made yourselves a golden calf. You had turned aside quickly from the way that the LORD had commanded You.
- 17 *And I took the two tables, and cast them out of my two hands, and brake them before your eyes.* So I took hold of the two tablets and threw them out of my two hands and broke them before Your eyes.
- 18 *And I fell down before the LORD, as at the first, forty days and forty nights: I did neither eat bread, nor drink water, because of all your sins which ye sinned, in doing wickedly in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.* Then I lay prostrate before the LORD as before, forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water, because of all the sin that You had committed, in doing what was evil in the sight of the LORD to provoke Him to anger.
- 19 *For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure, wherewith the LORD was wroth against you to destroy you. But the LORD hearkened unto me at that time also.* For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure that the LORD bore against You, so that He was ready to destroy You. But the LORD listened to me that time also.
- 20 *And the LORD was very angry with Aaron to have destroyed him: and I prayed for Aaron also the same time.* the LORD was so angry with Aaron that he was ready to destroy him. And I prayed for Aaron also at the same time.
- 21 *And I took your sin, the calf which ye had made, and burnt it with fire, and stamped it, and ground it very small, even until it was as small as dust: and I cast the dust thereof into the brook that descended out of the mount.* Then I took the sinful thing You had made, the calf, and burned it with fire and crushed it, grinding it very small, until it was as fine as dust. And I threw the dust of it into the brook that ran down from the mountain.
- 22 *And at Taberah, and at Massah, and at Kibrothhattaavah, ye provoked the LORD to wrath.* At Taberah also, and at Massah and at Kibroth-hattaavah, You provoked the LORD to wrath.

- 23 *Likewise when the LORD sent you from Kadeshbarnea, saying, Go up and possess the land which I have given you; then ye rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God, and ye believed him not, nor hearkened to his voice.* when the LORD sent You from Kadesh-barnea, saying, "Go up and take possession of the land that I have given You," then You rebelled against the command of the LORD Your God and did not believe Him or obey His voice.
- 24 *Ye have been rebellious against the LORD from the day that I knew you.* You have been rebellious against the LORD from the day that I knew You.
- 25 *Thus I fell down before the LORD forty days and forty nights, as I fell down at the first; because the LORD had said he would destroy you.* So I lay prostrate before the LORD for those forty days and forty nights, because the LORD had said He would destroy You.
- 26 *I prayed therefore unto the LORD, and said, O Lord GOD, destroy not thy people and thine inheritance, which thou hast redeemed through thy greatness, which thou hast brought forth out of Egypt with a mighty hand.* I prayed to the LORD, "O Lord GOD, do not destroy Your people and Your heritage, whom You have redeemed through Your greatness, whom You have brought out of Egypt with a mighty hand.
- 27 *Remember thy servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; look not unto the stubbornness of this people, nor to their wickedness, nor to their sin:* Remember your servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Do not regard the stubbornness of this people, or their wickedness or their sin,
- 28 *Lest the land whence thou broughtest us out say, Because the LORD was not able to bring them into the land which he promised them, and because he hated them, he hath brought them out to slay them in the wilderness.* lest the land from which You brought us say, 'Because the LORD was not able to bring them into the land that He promised them, and because He hated them, He has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness.'
- 29 *Yet they are thy people and thine inheritance, which thou broughtest out by thy mighty power and by thy stretched out arm.* For they are Your people and Your heritage, whom You brought out by Your great power and by Your outstretched arm."

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 11:31; Deut 1:28; Deut 4:38
- v3 — Deut 4:24; Rom 8:31; Heb 12:29; Deut 20:4; Deut 7:23-24
- v4 — Deut 8:17; Deut 9:5; 2 Tim 1:9; Deut 18:9-14
- v5 — Titus 3:5; Gen 17:8; Gen 26:4
- v9 — Ex 34:28; Ex 24:18
- v12 — Ex 32:7-8; Judg 2:17; Deut 31:29
- v14 — Deut 29:20; Ex 32:10-13
- v18 — Ex 34:28; Deut 9:9
- v19 — Deut 10:10; Ex 32:14; Jas 5:16-17
- v22 — Num 11:34; Ex 17:7; Num 11:1-5
- v25 — Deut 9:18
- v29 — Neh 1:10; Deut 4:34; Deut 9:26; 1 Kgs 8:51

Chapter 10

Moses recounts how the LORD gave him two new tablets of stone to replace the ones he broke, and how the ark was made to hold them. He reminds Israel that the LORD requires them to fear Him, walk in His ways, love Him, and serve Him with all their heart and soul.

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| <p>1 <i>At that time the LORD said unto me,
Hew thee two tables of stone like unto
the first, and come up unto me into the
mount, and make thee an ark of wood.</i></p> | <p>At that time the LORD said to me,
"Cut for Yourself two tablets of stone
like the first, and come up to me on the
mountain and make an ark of wood.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And I will write on the tables the
words that were in the first tables
which thou brakest, and thou shalt put
them in the ark.</i></p> | <p>I will write on the tablets the words
that were on the first tablets, which
You broke, and You shall put them in
the ark."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And I made an ark of shittim wood,
and hewed two tables of stone like
unto the first, and went up into the
mount, having the two tables in mine
hand.</i></p> | <p>So I made an ark of acacia wood, and
cut two tablets of stone like the first,
and went up the mountain with the two
tablets in my hand.</p> |

- 4 *And he wrote on the tables, according to the first writing, the ten commandments, which the LORD spake unto you in the mount out of the midst of the fire in the day of the assembly: and the LORD gave them unto me.* he wrote on the tablets, in the same writing as before, the Ten Commandments that the LORD had spoken to You on the mountain out of the midst of the fire on the day of the assembly. And the LORD gave them to me.
- 5 *And I turned myself and came down from the mount, and put the tables in the ark which I had made; and there they be, as the LORD commanded me.* Then I turned and came down from the mountain and put the tablets in the ark that I had made. And there they are, as the LORD commanded me.
- 6 *And the children of Israel took their journey from Beeroth of the children of Jaakan to Mosera: there Aaron died, and there he was buried; and Eleazar his son ministered in the priest's office in his stead.* (The people of Israel journeyed from Beeroth Bene-jaakan to Moserah. There Aaron died, and there he was buried. And his son Eleazar ministered as priest in his place.
- 7 *From thence they journeyed unto Gudgodah; and from Gudgodah to Jotbath, a land of rivers of waters.* From there they journeyed to Gudgodah, and from Gudgodah to Jotbathah, a land with brooks of water.)
- 8 *At that time the LORD separated the tribe of Levi, to bear the ark of the covenant of the LORD, to stand before the LORD to minister unto him, and to bless in his name, unto this day.* At that time the LORD set apart the tribe of Levi to carry the ark of the covenant of the LORD to stand before the LORD to minister to Him and to bless in His name, to this day.
- 9 *Wherefore Levi hath no part nor inheritance with his brethren; the LORD is his inheritance, according as the LORD thy God promised him.* Therefore Levi has no portion or inheritance with His brothers. The LORD is His inheritance, as the LORD Your God said to Him.
- 10 *And I stayed in the mount, according to the first time, forty days and forty nights; and the LORD hearkened unto me at that time also, and the LORD would not destroy thee.* I myself stayed on the mountain, as at the first time, forty days and forty nights. The LORD listened to me that time also. The LORD was unwilling to destroy You.

- 11 *And the LORD said unto me, Arise, take thy journey before the people, that they may go in and possess the land, which I swore unto their fathers to give unto them.* the LORD said to me, "Arise, go on Your journey at the head of the people, so that they may go in and possess the land, which I swore to their fathers to give them."
- 12 *And now, Israel, what doth the LORD thy God require of thee, but to fear the LORD thy God, to walk in all his ways, and to love him, and to serve the LORD thy God with all thy heart and with all thy soul,* now, Israel, what does the LORD Your God require of You, but to fear the LORD Your God, to walk in all His ways, to love Him, to serve the LORD Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul,
- 13 *To keep the commandments of the LORD, and his statutes, which I command thee this day for thy good?* to keep the commandments and statutes of the LORD, which I am commanding You today for Your good?
- 14 *Behold, the heaven and the heaven of heavens is the LORD's thy God, the earth also, with all that therein is.* See, to the LORD Your God belong heaven and the heaven of heavens, the earth with all that is in it.
- 15 *Only the LORD had a delight in thy fathers to love them, and he chose their seed after them, even you above all people, as it is this day.* Yet the LORD set His heart in love on Your fathers and chose their seed after them, You above all peoples, as it is this day.
- 16 *Circumcise therefore the foreskin of your heart, and be no more stiffnecked.* Circumcise therefore the foreskin of Your heart, and be no longer stubborn.
- 17 *For the LORD your God is God of gods, and Lord of lords, a great God, a mighty, and a terrible, which regardeth not persons, nor taketh reward:* For the LORD Your God is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great, the mighty, and the awesome God, Who is not partial and takes no bribe.
- 18 *He doth execute the judgment of the fatherless and widow, and loveth the stranger, in giving him food and raiment.* He executes justice for the fatherless and the widow, and loves the stranger, giving Him food and clothing.

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| 19 | <i>Love ye therefore the stranger: for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.</i> | Love the stranger therefore, for You were strangers in the land of Egypt. |
| 20 | <i>Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God; him shalt thou serve, and to him shalt thou cleave, and swear by his name.</i> | You shall fear the LORD Your God. You shall serve Him and hold fast to Him, and by His name You shall swear. |
| 21 | <i>He is thy praise, and he is thy God, that hath done for thee these great and terrible things, which thine eyes have seen.</i> | He is Your praise. He is Your God, Who has done for You these great and awesome things that Your eyes have seen. |
| 22 | <i>Thy fathers went down into Egypt with threescore and ten persons; and now the LORD thy God hath made thee as the stars of heaven for multitude.</i> | Your fathers went down to Egypt seventy persons, and now the LORD Your God has made You as numerous as the stars of heaven. |

Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

- v5 — Ex 34:29; Ex 40:20
- v8 — Deut 21:5; Deut 18:5; Num 4:15; Num 6:23-26; Num 3:6
- v12 — Mic 6:8; Deut 6:5; Luke 10:27; Deut 5:33; Deut 11:13
- v13 — Jer 32:39; Deut 6:24
- v14 — Ex 19:5; Ps 24:1; Ps 115:16; Neh 9:6; 1 Kgs 8:27
- v16 — Jer 4:4; Deut 30:6; Lev 26:41; Col 2:11; Rom 2:28-29
- v17 — Acts 10:34; Rom 2:11; Dan 2:47; Job 34:19; Gal 2:6
- v18 — Ps 146:9; Ps 68:5; Jer 49:11; Isa 1:17; Ps 145:9
- v19 — Lev 19:33-34; Ex 22:21
- v20 — Deut 6:13; Deut 13:4; Luke 4:8; Deut 11:22; Matt 4:10
- v21 — Jer 17:14; Rev 21:23; Ex 15:2
- v22 — Gen 46:27; Ex 1:5; Gen 15:5; Deut 1:10

Chapter 11

Moses urges Israel to love the LORD and keep His commandments, reminding them of the great things they saw with their own eyes in Egypt and the wilderness. He sets before them a blessing for obedience and a curse for disobedience, to be proclaimed from Mount Gerizim and Mount Ebal.

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| 1 <i>Therefore thou shalt love the LORD thy God, and keep his charge, and his statutes, and his judgments, and his commandments, always.</i> | You shall therefore love the LORD Your God and keep His charge, His statutes, His judgments, and His commandments always. |
| 2 <i>And know ye this day: for I speak not with your children which have not known, and which have not seen the chastisement of the LORD your God, his greatness, his mighty hand, and his stretched out arm,</i> | consider today (since I am not speaking to Your children who have not known or seen it), the discipline of the LORD Your God, His greatness, His mighty hand and His outstretched arm, |
| 3 <i>And his miracles, and his acts, which he did in the midst of Egypt unto Pharaoh the king of Egypt, and unto all his land;</i> | his signs and his deeds that he did in Egypt to Pharaoh the king of Egypt and to all his land, |
| 4 <i>And what he did unto the army of Egypt, unto their horses, and to their chariots; how he made the water of the Red sea to overflow them as they pursued after you, and how the LORD hath destroyed them unto this day;</i> | what He did to the army of Egypt, to their horses and to their chariots, how He made the water of the Red Sea flow over them as they pursued after You, and how the LORD has destroyed them to this day, |
| 5 <i>And what he did unto you in the wilderness, until ye came into this place;</i> | what He did to You in the wilderness until You came to this place, |
| 6 <i>And what he did unto Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, the son of Reuben: how the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up, and their households, and their tents, and all the substance that was in their possession, in the midst of all Israel:</i> | what He did to Dathan and Abiram the sons of Eliab, son of Reuben, how the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up, with their households, their tents, and every living thing that belonged to them, in the midst of all Israel. |

- 7 *But your eyes have seen all the great acts of the LORD which he did.* For Your eyes have seen all the great work of the LORD that He did.
- 8 *Therefore shall ye keep all the commandments which I command you this day, that ye may be strong, and go in and possess the land, whither ye go to possess it;* You shall therefore keep the whole commandment that I command You today, that You may be strong, and go in and take possession of the land that You are going over to possess,
- 9 *And that ye may prolong your days in the land, which the LORD sware unto your fathers to give unto them and to their seed, a land that floweth with milk and honey.* that You may live long in the land that the LORD swore to Your fathers to give to them and to their seed, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 10 *For the land, whither thou goest in to possess it, is not as the land of Egypt, from whence ye came out, where thou sowedst thy seed, and wateredst it with thy foot, as a garden of herbs:* For the land that You are entering to take possession of it is not like the land of Egypt, from which You have come, where You sowed Your seed and irrigated it, like a garden of vegetables.
- 11 *But the land, whither ye go to possess it, is a land of hills and valleys, and drinketh water of the rain of heaven:* But the land that You are going over to possess is a land of hills and valleys, which drinks water by the rain from heaven,
- 12 *A land which the LORD thy God careth for: the eyes of the LORD thy God are always upon it, from the beginning of the year even unto the end of the year.* a land that the LORD Your God cares for. The eyes of the LORD Your God are always on it, from the beginning of the year to the end of the year.
- 13 *And it shall come to pass, if ye shall hearken diligently unto my commandments which I command you this day, to love the LORD your God, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul,* if You will indeed obey my commandments that I command You today, to love the LORD Your God, and to serve Him with all Your heart and with all Your soul,

- 14 *That I will give you the rain of your land in his due season, the first rain and the latter rain, that thou mayest gather in thy corn, and thy wine, and thine oil.* he will give the rain for Your land in its season, the early rain and the later rain, that You may gather in Your grain and Your wine and Your oil.
- 15 *And I will send grass in thy fields for thy cattle, that thou mayest eat and be full.* he will give grass in Your fields for Your livestock, and You shall eat and be full.
- 16 *Take heed to yourselves, that your heart be not deceived, and ye turn aside, and serve other gods, and worship them;* Take care lest Your heart be deceived, and You turn aside and serve other gods and worship them;
- 17 *And then the LORD's wrath be kindled against you, and he shut up the heaven, that there be no rain, and that the land yield not her fruit; and lest ye perish quickly from off the good land which the LORD giveth you.* then the anger of the LORD will be kindled against You. He will shut up the heavens, so that there will be no rain, and the land will yield no fruit, and You will perish quickly off the good land that the LORD is giving You.
- 18 *Therefore shall ye lay up these my words in your heart and in your soul, and bind them for a sign upon your hand, that they may be as frontlets between your eyes.* You shall therefore lay up these words of mine in Your heart and in Your soul, and You shall bind them as a sign on Your hand. They shall be as frontlets between Your eyes.
- 19 *And ye shall teach them your children, speaking of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.* You shall teach them to Your children, talking of them when You are sitting in Your house, and when You are walking by the way, and when You lie down, and when You rise.
- 20 *And thou shalt write them upon the door posts of thine house, and upon thy gates:* You shall write them on the doorposts of Your house and on Your gates,

- 21 *That your days may be multiplied, and the days of your children, in the land which the LORD swore unto your fathers to give them, as the days of heaven upon the earth.* that Your days and the days of Your children may be multiplied in the land that the LORD swore to Your fathers to give them, as long as the heavens are above the earth.
- 22 *For if ye shall diligently keep all these commandments which I command you, to do them, to love the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, and to cleave unto him;* For if You will be careful to do all this commandment that I command You to do, loving the LORD Your God, walking in all His ways, and holding fast to Him,
- 23 *Then will the LORD drive out all these nations from before you, and ye shall possess greater nations and mightier than yourselves.* then the LORD will drive out all these nations before You, and You will dispossess nations greater and mightier than You.
- 24 *Every place whereon the soles of your feet shall tread shall be yours: from the wilderness and Lebanon, from the river, the river Euphrates, even unto the uttermost sea shall your coast be.* Every place on which the sole of Your foot treads shall be Yours. Your territory shall be from the wilderness to Lebanon and from the River, the river Euphrates, to the western sea.
- 25 *There shall no man be able to stand before you: for the LORD your God shall lay the fear of you and the dread of you upon all the land that ye shall tread upon, as he hath said unto you.* No one shall be able to stand against you. The LORD Your God will lay the fear of You and the dread of You on all the land that You shall tread, as He promised You.
- 26 *Behold, I set before you this day a blessing and a curse;* See, I am setting before You today a blessing and a curse:
- 27 *A blessing, if ye obey the commandments of the LORD your God, which I command you this day:* the blessing, if You obey the commandments of the LORD Your God, which I command You today,
- 28 *And a curse, if ye will not obey the commandments of the LORD your God, but turn aside out of the way which I command you this day, to go after other gods, which ye have not known.* the curse, if You do not obey the commandments of the LORD Your God, but turn aside from the way that I am commanding You today, to go after other gods that You have not known.

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| <p>29 <i>And it shall come to pass, when the LORD thy God hath brought thee in unto the land whither thou goest to possess it, that thou shalt put the blessing upon mount Gerizim, and the curse upon mount Ebal.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Are they not on the other side Jordan, by the way where the sun goeth down, in the land of the Canaanites, which dwell in the plain over against Gilgal, beside the plains of Moreh?</i></p> <p>31 <i>For ye shall pass over Jordan to go in to possess the land which the LORD your God giveth you, and ye shall possess it, and dwell therein.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And ye shall observe to do all the statutes and judgments which I set before you this day.</i></p> | <p>when the LORD Your God brings You into the land that You are entering to take possession of it, You shall set the blessing on Mount Gerizim and the curse on Mount Ebal.</p> <p>Are they not beyond the Jordan, west of the road, toward the going down of the sun, in the land of the Canaanites who live in the Arabah, opposite Gilgal, beside the oak of Moreh?</p> <p>For You are to cross the Jordan to go in to take possession of the land that the LORD Your God is giving You. And when You possess it and live in it, you shall be careful to do all the statutes and the rules that I am setting before You today.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 6:5; Deut 10:12; Luke 1:74-75; Deut 30:16-20; Deut 6:1
- v8 — Eph 6:10; Josh 1:6-7; Phil 4:13; Eph 3:16
- v11 — Heb 6:7; Deut 8:7-9; Ps 65:12-13; Gen 27:28; Jer 2:7
- v12 — Jer 24:6; Ps 33:18; 1 Kgs 9:3; Ps 34:15; Ezra 5:5
- v14 — Jas 5:7; Lev 26:4; Ezek 34:26; Deut 28:12; Joel 2:22-23
- v17 — 1 Kgs 8:35; Deut 6:15; 2 Chr 6:26; Amos 4:7; 1 Kgs 17:1
- v18 — Col 3:16; Deut 6:6-9; Prov 3:1; Ps 119:11; 2 Pet 3:1-2
- v19 — Deut 6:7; Ps 34:11; Deut 4:9-10; Isa 38:19; Prov 2:1
- v24 — Josh 14:9; Ex 23:31; Gen 15:18-21; 1 Kgs 4:21; 2 Chr 9:26
- v25 — Deut 7:24; Ex 23:27; Josh 1:5; Josh 5:1; Deut 2:25
- v26 — Deut 30:15-20; Deut 30:1; Gal 3:10

v27 — Isa 1:19; Deut 28:1-14; Isa 3:10; Luke 11:28; Lev 26:3-13

Chapter 12

Moses commands Israel to destroy all the pagan worship sites in the land and to bring their sacrifices only to the place the LORD chooses. He permits the eating of meat in any town but forbids the eating of blood, which must be poured out on the ground like water.

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| <p>1 <i>These are the statutes and judgments, which ye shall observe to do in the land, which the LORD God of thy fathers giveth thee to possess it, all the days that ye live upon the earth.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Ye shall utterly destroy all the places, wherein the nations which ye shall possess served their gods, upon the high mountains, and upon the hills, and under every green tree:</i></p> <p>3 <i>And ye shall overthrow their altars, and break their pillars, and burn their groves with fire; and ye shall hew down the graven images of their gods, and destroy the names of them out of that place.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Ye shall not do so unto the LORD your God.</i></p> <p>5 <i>But unto the place which the LORD your God shall choose out of all your tribes to put his name there, even unto his habitation shall ye seek, and thither thou shalt come:</i></p> <p>6 <i>And thither ye shall bring your burnt offerings, and your sacrifices, and your tithes, and heave offerings of your hand, and your vows, and your freewill offerings, and the firstlings of your herds and of your flocks:</i></p> | <p>These are the statutes and rules that You shall be careful to do in the land that the LORD, the God of Your fathers, has given You to possess, all the days that You live on the earth.</p> <p>You shall surely destroy all the places where the nations whom you shall dispossess served their gods, on the high mountains and on the hills and under every green tree.</p> <p>You shall tear down their altars and dash in pieces their pillars and burn their groves with fire. You shall chop down the carved images of their gods and destroy their name out of that place.</p> <p>You shall not worship the LORD Your God in that way.</p> <p>But You shall seek the place that the LORD Your God will choose out of all Your tribes to put His name and make His dwelling there. There You shall go,</p> <p>there You shall bring Your burnt offerings and Your sacrifices, Your tithes and the contribution that You present, Your vow offerings, Your freewill offerings, and the firstborn of Your herd and of Your flock.</p> |
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- 7 *And there ye shall eat before the LORD your God, and ye shall rejoice in all that ye put your hand unto, ye and your households, wherein the LORD thy God hath blessed thee.* there You shall eat before the LORD Your God, and You shall rejoice, You and Your households, in all that You undertake, in which the LORD Your God has blessed You.
- 8 *Ye shall not do after all the things that we do here this day, every man whatsoever is right in his own eyes.* You shall not do according to all that we are doing here today, everyone doing whatever is right in His own eyes,
- 9 *For ye are not as yet come to the rest and to the inheritance, which the LORD your God giveth you.* for You have not yet come to the rest and to the inheritance that the LORD Your God is giving You.
- 10 *But when ye go over Jordan, and dwell in the land which the LORD your God giveth you to inherit, and when he giveth you rest from all your enemies round about, so that ye dwell in safety;* But when You go over the Jordan and live in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You to inherit, and when He gives You rest from all Your enemies around You, so that You live in safety,
- 11 *Then there shall be a place which the LORD your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell there; thither shall ye bring all that I command you; your burnt offerings, and your sacrifices, your tithes, and the heave offering of your hand, and all your choice vows which ye vow unto the LORD:* then to the place that the LORD Your God will choose, to make His name dwell there, there You shall bring all that I command You: Your burnt offerings and Your sacrifices, Your tithes and the contribution that You present. All Your finest vow offerings that You vow to the LORD.
- 12 *And ye shall rejoice before the LORD your God, ye, and your sons, and your daughters, and your menservants, and your maidservants, and the Levite that is within your gates; forasmuch as he hath no part nor inheritance with you.* you shall rejoice before the LORD Your God, You and Your sons and Your daughters, Your male servants and Your female servants, and the Levite that is within Your towns, since He has no portion or inheritance with You.

- 13 *Take heed to thyself that thou offer not thy burnt offerings in every place that thou seest:* Take care that You do not offer Your burnt offerings at any place that You see,
- 14 *But in the place which the LORD shall choose in one of thy tribes, there thou shalt offer thy burnt offerings, and there thou shalt do all that I command thee.* but only at the place that the LORD will choose in one of Your tribes. There You shall offer Your burnt offerings, and there You shall do all that I am commanding You.
- 15 *Notwithstanding thou mayest kill and eat flesh in all thy gates, whatsoever thy soul lusteth after, according to the blessing of the LORD thy God which he hath given thee: the unclean and the clean may eat thereof, as of the roebuck, and as of the hart.* However, You may slaughter and eat meat within any of Your towns, as much as You desire, according to the blessing of the LORD Your God that He has given You. The unclean and the clean may eat of it, as of the gazelle and as of the deer.
- 16 *Only ye shall not eat the blood; ye shall pour it upon the earth as water.* Only You shall not eat the blood; You shall pour it out on the ground like water.
- 17 *Thou mayest not eat within thy gates the tithe of thy corn, or of thy wine, or of thy oil, or the firstlings of thy herds or of thy flock, nor any of thy vows which thou vowest, nor thy freewill offerings, or heave offering of thine hand:* You may not eat within Your towns the tithe of Your grain or of Your wine or of Your oil, or the firstborn of Your herd or of Your flock, or any of Your vow offerings that You vow, or Your freewill offerings or the contribution that You present,
- 18 *But thou must eat them before the LORD thy God in the place which the LORD thy God shall choose, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates: and thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God in all that thou puttest thine hands unto.* but You shall eat them before the LORD Your God in the place that the LORD Your God will choose, You and Your son and Your daughter, Your male servant and Your female servant, and the Levite who is within Your towns. And You shall rejoice before the LORD Your God in all that You undertake.

- 19 *Take heed to thyself that thou forsake not the Levite as long as thou livest upon the earth.* Take care that You do not neglect the Levite as long as You live in Your land.
- 20 *When the LORD thy God shall enlarge thy border, as he hath promised thee, and thou shalt say, I will eat flesh, because thy soul longeth to eat flesh; thou mayest eat flesh, whatsoever thy soul lusteth after.* When the LORD Your God enlarges Your territory, as He has promised You, and You say, "I will eat meat," because You crave meat, You may eat meat whenever You desire.
- 21 *If the place which the LORD thy God hath chosen to put his name there be too far from thee, then thou shalt kill of thy herd and of thy flock, which the LORD hath given thee, as I have commanded thee, and thou shalt eat in thy gates whatsoever thy soul lusteth after.* If the place that the LORD Your God will choose to put His name there is too far from You, then You may kill any of Your herd or Your flock that the LORD has given You, as I have commanded You, and You may eat within Your towns whenever You desire.
- 22 *Even as the roebuck and the hart is eaten, so thou shalt eat them: the unclean and the clean shall eat of them alike.* Just as the gazelle or the deer is eaten, so You may eat of it. The unclean and the clean alike may eat of it.
- 23 *Only be sure that thou eat not the blood: for the blood is the life; and thou mayest not eat the life with the flesh.* Only be sure that You do not eat the blood, for the blood is the life, and You shall not eat the life with the flesh.
- 24 *Thou shalt not eat it; thou shalt pour it upon the earth as water.* You shall not eat it; You shall pour it out on the earth like water.
- 25 *Thou shalt not eat it; that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee, when thou shalt do that which is right in the sight of the LORD.* You shall not eat it, that all may go well with You and with Your children after You, when You do what is right in the sight of the LORD.

- 26 *Only thy holy things which thou hast, and thy vows, thou shalt take, and go unto the place which the LORD shall choose:* But the holy things that are due from You, and Your vow offerings, You shall take, and You shall go to the place that the LORD will choose,
- 27 *And thou shalt offer thy burnt offerings, the flesh and the blood, upon the altar of the LORD thy God: and the blood of thy sacrifices shall be poured out upon the altar of the LORD thy God, and thou shalt eat the flesh.* offer Your burnt offerings, the flesh and the blood, on the altar of the LORD Your God. The blood of Your sacrifices shall be poured out on the altar of the LORD Your God, but the flesh You may eat.
- 28 *Observe and hear all these words which I command thee, that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee for ever, when thou doest that which is good and right in the sight of the LORD thy God.* Be careful to obey all these words that I command You, that it may go well with You and with Your children after You forever, when You do what is good and right in the sight of the LORD Your God.
- 29 *When the LORD thy God shall cut off the nations from before thee, whither thou goest to possess them, and thou succeedest them, and dwellest in their land;* When the LORD Your God cuts off before You the nations whom you go in to dispossess, and you dispossess them and dwell in their land,
- 30 *Take heed to thyself that thou be not snared by following them, after that they be destroyed from before thee; and that thou enquire not after their gods, saying, How did these nations serve their gods? even so will I do likewise.* take care that You be not ensnared to follow them, after they have been destroyed before You, and that You do not inquire about their gods, saying, "How did these nations serve their gods?—that I also may do the same."
- 31 *Thou shalt not do so unto the LORD thy God: for every abomination to the LORD, which he hateth, have they done unto their gods; for even their sons and their daughters they have burnt in the fire to their gods.* You shall not worship the LORD Your God in that way, for every abominable thing that the LORD hates they have done for their gods, for they even burn their sons and their daughters in the fire to their gods.

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| <p>32 <i>What thing soever I command you, observe to do it: thou shalt not add thereto, nor diminish from it.</i></p> | <p>Everything that I command You, You shall be careful to do. You shall not add to it or take from it.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 7:5; Num 33:51-52; 2 Kgs 16:4
- v3 — Zech 13:2; Num 33:52; Judg 2:2
- v5 — Deut 12:11; Deut 26:2; 2 Chr 7:12; Deut 16:2; 1 Kgs 8:29
- v7 — Deut 12:18; Deut 14:26; Lev 23:40; Deut 12:12
- v8 — Judg 21:25; Judg 17:6; Prov 21:2
- v12 — Deut 12:7; Deut 10:9; Deut 26:12; Deut 12:19; Deut 14:29
- v20 — Deut 19:8; Deut 11:24; Ex 34:24
- v23 — Lev 17:11; Gen 9:4; Lev 17:13-14; Lev 3:16-17; Deut 12:16
- v25 — Deut 4:40; Isa 3:10; Ex 15:26; 1 Kgs 11:38
- v27 — Lev 1:13; Lev 1:9; Lev 17:11
- v31 — Jer 32:35; Jer 7:31; Deut 18:9-10; 2 Kgs 17:15-17; 2 Kgs 21:2
- v32 — Deut 4:2; Rev 22:18-19; Josh 1:7; Prov 30:6; Deut 13:18

Chapter 13

Moses gives laws for dealing with those who entice Israel to worship other gods. A false prophet, a close family member, or the inhabitants of a city who lead others into idolatry are all to be put to death without pity.

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| <p>1 <i>If there arise among you a prophet, or a dreamer of dreams, and giveth thee a sign or a wonder,</i></p> | <p>If a prophet or a dreamer of dreams arises among you and gives you a sign or a wonder,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the sign or the wonder come to pass, whereof he spake unto thee, saying, Let us go after other gods, which thou hast not known, and let us serve them;</i></p> | <p>the sign or wonder that he tells you comes to pass, and if he says, "Let us go after other gods," which you have not known, "and let us serve them,"</p> |

- 3 *Thou shalt not hearken unto the words of that prophet, or that dreamer of dreams: for the LORD your God proveth you, to know whether ye love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul.* you shall not listen to the words of that prophet or that dreamer of dreams. For the LORD Your God is testing You, to know whether You love the LORD Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul.
- 4 *Ye shall walk after the LORD your God, and fear him, and keep his commandments, and obey his voice, and ye shall serve him, and cleave unto him.* You shall walk after the LORD Your God and fear Him and keep His commandments and obey His voice, and You shall serve Him and hold fast to Him.
- 5 *And that prophet, or that dreamer of dreams, shall be put to death; because he hath spoken to turn you away from the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, to thrust thee out of the way which the LORD thy God commanded thee to walk in. So shalt thou put the evil away from the midst of thee.* But that prophet or that dreamer of dreams shall be put to death, because He has taught rebellion against the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt and redeemed You out of the house of slavery, to make You leave the way in which the LORD Your God commanded You to walk. So You shall purge the evil from Your midst.
- 6 *If thy brother, the son of thy mother, or thy son, or thy daughter, or the wife of thy bosom, or thy friend, which is as thine own soul, entice thee secretly, saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which thou hast not known, thou, nor thy fathers;* If Your brother, the son of Your mother, or Your son or Your daughter or the wife You embrace or Your friend who is as Your own soul entices You secretly, saying, "Let us go and serve other gods," which neither You nor Your fathers have known,
- 7 *Namely, of the gods of the people which are round about you, nigh unto thee, or far off from thee, from the one end of the earth even unto the other end of the earth;* some of the gods of the peoples who are around You, whether near You or far off from You, from the one end of the earth to the other,

- 8 *Thou shalt not consent unto him, nor hearken unto him; neither shall thine eye pity him, neither shalt thou spare, neither shalt thou conceal him:* you shall not yield to Him or listen to Him, nor shall Your eye pity Him, nor shall You spare Him, nor shall You conceal Him.
- 9 *But thou shalt surely kill him; thine hand shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterwards the hand of all the people.* But You shall kill Him. Your hand shall be first against Him to put Him to death, and afterward the hand of all the people.
- 10 *And thou shalt stone him with stones, that he die; because he hath sought to thrust thee away from the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.* You shall stone Him to death with stones, because He sought to draw You away from the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery.
- 11 *And all Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall do no more any such wickedness as this is among you.* all Israel shall hear and fear and never again do any such wickedness as this among You.
- 12 *If thou shalt hear say in one of thy cities, which the LORD thy God hath given thee to dwell there, saying,* If You hear in one of Your cities, which the LORD Your God is giving You to dwell there,
- 13 *Certain men, the children of Belial, are gone out from among you, and have withdrawn the inhabitants of their city, saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which ye have not known;* that certain worthless fellows have gone out among You and have drawn away the inhabitants of their city, saying, "Let us go and serve other gods," which You have not known,
- 14 *Then shalt thou enquire, and make search, and ask diligently; and, behold, if it be truth, and the thing certain, that such abomination is wrought among you;* then You shall inquire and make search and ask diligently. And if it be true and certain that such an abomination has been done among You,
- 15 *Thou shalt surely smite the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying it utterly, and all that is therein, and the cattle thereof, with the edge of the sword.* you shall surely put the inhabitants of that city to the sword, devoting it to destruction, all who are in it and its livestock, with the edge of the sword.

- 16 *And thou shalt gather all the spoil of it into the midst of the street thereof, and shalt burn with fire the city, and all the spoil thereof every whit, for the LORD thy God: and it shall be an heap for ever; it shall not be built again.* You shall gather all its spoil into the midst of its open square and burn the city and all its spoil with fire, as a whole burnt offering to the LORD Your God. It shall be a heap forever. It shall not be built again.
- 17 *And there shall cleave nought of the cursed thing to thine hand: that the LORD may turn from the fierceness of his anger, and shew thee mercy, and have compassion upon thee, and multiply thee, as he hath sworn unto thy fathers;* None of the devoted things shall stick to Your hand, that the LORD may turn from His burning anger and show You mercy and have compassion on You and multiply You, as He swore to Your fathers,
- 18 *When thou shalt hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep all his commandments which I command thee this day, to do that which is right in the eyes of the LORD thy God.* if You obey the voice of the LORD Your God, keeping all His commandments that I am commanding You today, and doing what is right in the sight of the LORD Your God.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 23:25-28; 1 John 4:1; Jer 29:8; Jer 27:9; 1 Kgs 13:18
v3 — Deut 8:2; Ps 66:10; 1 Cor 11:19
v4 — Col 1:10; Deut 10:20; 1 Cor 6:17; Jer 7:23; 2 Chr 34:31
v6 — Deut 17:2-7; 1 John 2:26-27; 2 Pet 2:1; Eph 4:14
v8 — Prov 1:10; Deut 19:13
v11 — Deut 19:20
v13 — 1 John 2:19
v14 — Deut 17:4
v16 — Jer 49:2; Josh 8:28
v18 — Deut 12:28

Chapter 14

Moses restates the laws of clean and unclean animals, listing which may and may not be eaten. He commands Israel to tithe all the yield of their seed each year and to give a special tithe every third year for the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow.

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| <p>1 <i>Ye are the children of the LORD your God: ye shall not cut yourselves, nor make any baldness between your eyes for the dead.</i></p> <p>2 <i>For thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God, and the LORD hath chosen thee to be a peculiar people unto himself, above all the nations that are upon the earth.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Thou shalt not eat any abominable thing.</i></p> <p>4 <i>These are the beasts which ye shall eat: the ox, the sheep, and the goat,</i></p> <p>5 <i>The hart, and the roebuck, and the fallow deer, and the wild goat, and the pygarg, and the wild ox, and the chamois.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And every beast that parteth the hoof, and cleaveth the cleft into two claws, and cheweth the cud among the beasts, that ye shall eat.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Nevertheless these ye shall not eat of them that chew the cud, or of them that divide the cloven hoof; even the camel, and the hare, and the coney: for they chew the cud, but divide not the hoof; therefore they are unclean unto you.</i></p> | <p>You are the children of the LORD Your God. You shall not cut yourselves or make any baldness on Your foreheads for the dead.</p> <p>For You are a people holy to the LORD Your God. The LORD has chosen You to be a people for His treasured possession, out of all the peoples who are on the face of the earth.</p> <p>You shall not eat any abomination.</p> <p>These are the animals You may eat: the ox, the sheep, the goat, the deer, the gazelle, the roebuck, the wild goat, the ibex, the antelope, and the mountain sheep.</p> <p>Every animal that parts the hoof and has the hoof cloven in two and chews the cud, among the animals, You may eat.</p> <p>Yet of those that chew the cud or have the hoof cloven You shall not eat these: the camel, the hare, and the rock badger, because they chew the cud but do not part the hoof, are unclean for You.</p> |
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- 8 *And the swine, because it divideth the hoof, yet cheweth not the cud, it is unclean unto you: ye shall not eat of their flesh, nor touch their dead carcase.* the pig, because it parts the hoof but does not chew the cud, is unclean for You. Their flesh You shall not eat. Their carcasses You shall not touch.
- 9 *These ye shall eat of all that are in the waters: all that have fins and scales shall ye eat:* Of all that are in the waters You may eat these: whatever has fins and scales You may eat.
- 10 *And whatsoever hath not fins and scales ye may not eat; it is unclean unto you.* whatever does not have fins and scales You shall not eat; it is unclean for You.
- 11 *Of all clean birds ye shall eat.* You may eat all clean birds.
- 12 *But these are they of which ye shall not eat: the eagle, and the ossifrage, and the ospray,* But these are the ones You shall not eat: the eagle, the ossifrage, and the ospray,
- 13 *And the glede, and the kite, and the vulture after his kind,* the glede, and the kite, and the vulture after His kind;
- 14 *And every raven after his kind,* every raven of any kind;
- 15 *And the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after his kind,* the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after His kind;
- 16 *The little owl, and the great owl, and the swan,* the little owl, and the great owl, and the swan;
- 17 *And the pelican, and the gier eagle, and the cormorant,* and the pelican, and the gier eagle, and the cormorant,
- 18 *And the stork, and the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and the bat.* the stork, and the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and the bat.
- 19 *And every creeping thing that flieth is unclean unto you: they shall not be eaten.* all winged insects are unclean for You; they shall not be eaten.
- 20 *But of all clean fowls ye may eat.* All clean winged things You may eat.

- 21 *Ye shall not eat of any thing that dieth of itself; thou shalt give it unto the stranger that is in thy gates, that he may eat it; or thou mayest sell it unto an alien: for thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother's milk.* You shall not eat anything that has died naturally. You may give it to the stranger who is within Your towns, that He may eat it, or You may sell it to a foreigner, for You are a people holy to the LORD Your God. You shall not boil a young goat in its mother's milk.
- 22 *Thou shalt truly tithe all the increase of thy seed, that the field bringeth forth year by year.* You shall tithe all the yield of Your seed that comes from the field year by year.
- 23 *And thou shalt eat before the LORD thy God, in the place which he shall choose to place his name there, the tithe of thy corn, of thy wine, and of thine oil, and the firstlings of thy herds and of thy flocks; that thou mayest learn to fear the LORD thy God always.* before the LORD Your God, in the place that He will choose, to make His name dwell there, You shall eat the tithe of Your grain, of Your wine, and of Your oil, and the firstborn of Your herd and flock, that You may learn to fear the LORD Your God always.
- 24 *And if the way be too long for thee, so that thou art not able to carry it; or if the place be too far from thee, which the LORD thy God shall choose to set his name there, when the LORD thy God hath blessed thee:* if the way is too long for You, so that You are not able to carry the tithe, when the LORD Your God blesses You, because the place is too far from You, which the LORD Your God chooses, to set His name there,
- 25 *Then shalt thou turn it into money, and bind up the money in thine hand, and shalt go unto the place which the LORD thy God shall choose:* then You shall turn it into money and bind up the money in Your hand and go to the place that the LORD Your God chooses

- 26 *And thou shalt bestow that money for whatsoever thy soul lusteth after, for oxen, or for sheep, or for wine, or for strong drink, or for whatsoever thy soul desireth: and thou shalt eat there before the LORD thy God, and thou shalt rejoice, thou, and thine household,* spend the money for whatever You desire—oxen or sheep or wine or strong drink, whatever Your appetite craves. And You shall eat there before the LORD Your God and rejoice, You and Your household.
- 27 *And the Levite that is within thy gates; thou shalt not forsake him; for he hath no part nor inheritance with thee.* you shall not neglect the Levite who is within Your towns, for He has no portion or inheritance with You.
- 28 *At the end of three years thou shalt bring forth all the tithe of thine increase the same year, and shalt lay it up within thy gates:* At the end of every three years You shall bring out all the tithe of Your produce in the same year and lay it up within Your towns.
- 29 *And the Levite, (because he hath no part nor inheritance with thee,) and the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, which are within thy gates, shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hand which thou doest.* the Levite, because He has no portion or inheritance with You, and the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, who are within Your towns, shall come and eat and be filled, that the LORD Your God may bless You in all the work of Your hands that You do.

Words in this chapter:

cuckow (*KOO-koo*) — KJV spelling for the cuckoo — an unclean bird in the Law; some scholars think it refers to the sea gull or short-eared owl.

gier eagle (*GEER EE-gul*) — An unclean bird in the Law — likely the Egyptian vulture; its name comes from the German 'geier' meaning vulture.

lapwing (*LAP-wing*) — An unclean bird in the Law — likely the hoopoe (a crested bird with a long bill); listed in Leviticus 11 and Deuteronomy 14 among birds not to be eaten.

ospray (*OS-pray*) — A large fish-hunting bird of prey forbidden as food in the Law — likely the osprey or a similar eagle-like bird.

ossifrage (*OS-ih-frij*) — A large bird of prey forbidden as food in the Law — likely the bearded vulture or lammergeier; its name means 'bone-breaker.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gal 3:26; Rom 9:8; Lev 21:5; Rom 9:26; Jer 16:6
 v2 — Deut 7:6; Lev 20:26; Ex 19:5-6; Deut 26:18-19; 1 Pet 2:9
 v3 — Ezek 4:14
 v8 — Lev 11:26-27
 v21 — Ex 23:19; Ex 34:26; Lev 22:8
 v22 — Deut 12:6; Deut 12:17; Deut 26:12-15; Num 18:21; Neh 10:37
 v26 — Eccl 9:7
 v27 — Deut 14:29; Num 18:20; Deut 12:12; Deut 12:18-19; Deut 18:1-2
 v29 — Deut 15:10; Deut 14:27; Prov 19:17

Chapter 15

Moses gives the law of the sabbatical year: every seventh year, debts owed by fellow Israelites are to be released. He commands generosity toward the poor and gives laws concerning the release of Hebrew servants in the seventh year, sending them away liberally provided.

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| 1 | <i>At the end of every seven years thou shalt make a release.</i> | At the end of every seven years you shall grant a release. |
| 2 | <i>And this is the manner of the release: Every creditor that lendeth ought unto his neighbour shall release it; he shall not exact it of his neighbour, or of his brother; because it is called the LORD's release.</i> | this is the manner of the release: every creditor shall release what He has lent to His neighbor. He shall not exact it of His neighbor, His brother, because the LORD's release has been proclaimed. |
| 3 | <i>Of a foreigner thou mayest exact it again: but that which is thine with thy brother thine hand shall release;</i> | Of a foreigner You may exact it, but whatever of Yours is with Your brother Your hand shall release. |
| 4 | <i>Save when there shall be no poor among you; for the LORD shall greatly bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance to possess it:</i> | But there will be no poor among You; for the LORD will bless You in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance to possess— |
| 5 | <i>Only if thou carefully hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe to do all these commandments which I command thee this day.</i> | if only You will strictly obey the voice of the LORD Your God, being careful to do all this commandment that I command You today. |

- 6 *For the LORD thy God blesseth thee, as he promised thee: and thou shalt lend unto many nations, but thou shalt not borrow; and thou shalt reign over many nations, but they shall not reign over thee.* For the LORD Your God will bless You, as He promised You, and You shall lend to many nations, but You shall not borrow, and You shall rule over many nations. But they shall not rule over You.
- 7 *If there be among you a poor man of one of thy brethren within any of thy gates in thy land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, thou shalt not harden thine heart, nor shut thine hand from thy poor brother:* If among You, one of Your brothers should become poor, in any of Your towns within Your land that the LORD Your God is giving You, You shall not harden Your heart or shut Your hand against Your poor brother,
- 8 *But thou shalt open thine hand wide unto him, and shalt surely lend him sufficient for his need, in that which he wanteth.* but You shall open wide Your hand to Him and lend Him sufficient for His need, whatever it may be.
- 9 *Beware that there be not a thought in thy wicked heart, saying, The seventh year, the year of release, is at hand; and thine eye be evil against thy poor brother, and thou givest him nought; and he cry unto the LORD against thee, and it be sin unto thee.* Take care lest there be an unworthy thought in Your heart and You say, "The seventh year, the year of release is near," and Your eye look grudgingly on Your poor brother, and You give Him nothing. He cry to the LORD against You, and You be guilty of sin.
- 10 *Thou shalt surely give him, and thine heart shall not be grieved when thou givest unto him: because that for this thing the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thy works, and in all that thou puttest thine hand unto.* You shall give to Him freely, and Your heart shall not be grudging when You give to Him, because for this the LORD Your God will bless You in all Your work and in all that You undertake.
- 11 *For the poor shall never cease out of the land: therefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy, in thy land.* For there will never cease to be poor in the land. Therefore I command You, "You shall open wide Your hand to Your brother, to the needy and to the poor, in Your land."

- 12 *And if thy brother, an Hebrew man, or an Hebrew woman, be sold unto thee, and serve thee six years; then in the seventh year thou shalt let him go free from thee.* If Your brother, a Hebrew man, or a Hebrew woman, is sold to You, He shall serve You six years, and in the seventh year You shall let Him go free from You.
- 13 *And when thou sendest him out free from thee, thou shalt not let him go away empty:* when You let Him go free from You, You shall not let Him go empty-handed.
- 14 *Thou shalt furnish him liberally out of thy flock, and out of thy floor, and out of thy winepress: of that wherewith the LORD thy God hath blessed thee thou shalt give unto him.* You shall furnish Him liberally out of Your flock, out of Your threshing floor, and out of Your winepress. As the LORD Your God has blessed You, You shall give to Him.
- 15 *And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in the land of Egypt, and the LORD thy God redeemed thee: therefore I command thee this thing to day.* You shall remember that You were a slave in the land of Egypt. The LORD Your God redeemed You; therefore I command You this today.
- 16 *And it shall be, if he say unto thee, I will not go away from thee; because he loveth thee and thine house, because he is well with thee;* But if He says to You, "I will not go out from You," because He loves You and Your household, since He is well off with You,
- 17 *Then thou shalt take an aul, and thrust it through his ear unto the door, and he shall be thy servant for ever. And also unto thy maidservant thou shalt do likewise.* then You shall take an awl, and put it through His ear into the door. He shall be Your slave forever. And to Your female slave You shall do the same.
- 18 *It shall not seem hard unto thee, when thou sendest him away free from thee; for he hath been worth a double hired servant to thee, in serving thee six years: and the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all that thou doest.* It shall not seem hard to You when You let Him go free from You, for at half the cost of a hired worker He has served You six years. And the LORD Your God will bless You in all that You do.

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| <p>19 <i>All the firstling males that come of thy herd and of thy flock thou shalt sanctify unto the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work with the firstling of thy bullock, neither shear the firstling of thy sheep.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Thou shalt eat it before the LORD thy God year by year in the place which the LORD shall choose, thou and thy household.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And if there be any blemish therein, as if it be lame, or blind, or have any ill blemish, thou shalt not sacrifice it unto the LORD thy God.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Thou shalt eat it within thy gates: the unclean and the clean person shall eat it alike, as the roebuck, and as the hart.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Only thou shalt not eat the blood thereof; thou shalt pour it upon the ground as water.</i></p> | <p>All the firstborn males that are born of Your herd and flock You shall dedicate to the LORD Your God. You shall do no work with the firstborn of Your herd, nor shear the firstborn of Your flock.</p> <p>You shall eat it, You and Your household, before the LORD Your God year by year at the place that the LORD will choose.</p> <p>But if it has any blemish, if it is lame or blind or has any serious blemish whatever, You shall not sacrifice it to the LORD Your God.</p> <p>You shall eat it within Your towns. The unclean and the clean alike may eat it, as though it were a gazelle or a deer.</p> <p>Only You shall not eat its blood; You shall pour it out on the ground like water.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

release (*ree-LEES*) — the cancellation of debts every seventh year; a Sabbath principle applied to the poor

bondman (*BOND-man*) — a servant bound to a master; the law regulates the treatment and eventual release of Hebrew servants

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 31:10; Lev 25:2-4; Ex 23:10-11

v2 — Luke 7:42; Jas 2:13

v3 — Deut 23:20

v4 — Prov 28:27; Isa 58:10-11; Prov 11:24-25; Deut 28:1-8; Deut 14:29

v6 — Deut 28:12-13; 1 Kgs 4:21; Luke 6:35; Neh 9:27; Prov 22:7

v7 — Deut 15:9; Prov 21:13; 1 John 3:16-17

v9 — Deut 24:15; Matt 20:15

v10 — Prov 22:9; Heb 13:16; Deut 14:29; 1 Tim 6:18-19; Ps 41:1-2

v11 — Mark 14:7; Matt 26:11; John 12:8; Deut 15:8; Prov 22:2

v12 — Jer 34:14; Ex 21:2-6; Lev 25:39-41

v16 — Ex 21:5-6

v19 — Ex 13:2

Chapter 16

Moses commands the observance of the three pilgrimage feasts -- Passover, the Feast of Weeks, and the Feast of Tabernacles -- at the place the LORD chooses. He instructs Israel to appoint judges and officers who will judge the people with righteous judgment.

- 1 *Observe the month of Abib, and keep the passover unto the LORD thy God: for in the month of Abib the LORD thy God brought thee forth out of Egypt by night.* Observe the month of Abib and keep the Passover to the LORD Your God, for in the month of Abib the LORD Your God brought You out of Egypt by night.
- 2 *Thou shalt therefore sacrifice the passover unto the LORD thy God, of the flock and the herd, in the place which the LORD shall choose to place his name there.* you shall offer the Passover sacrifice to the LORD Your God, from the flock or the herd, at the place that the LORD will choose, to make His name dwell there.
- 3 *Thou shalt eat no leavened bread with it; seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread therewith, even the bread of affliction; for thou camest forth out of the land of Egypt in haste: that thou mayest remember the day when thou camest forth out of the land of Egypt all the days of thy life.* You shall eat no leavened bread with it. Seven days You shall eat it with unleavened bread, the bread of affliction—for You came out of the land of Egypt in haste—that all the days of Your life You may remember the day when You came out of the land of Egypt.
- 4 *And there shall be no leavened bread seen with thee in all thy coast seven days; neither shall there any thing of the flesh, which thou sacrificedst the first day at even, remain all night until the morning.* No leaven shall be seen with You in all Your territory for seven days, nor shall any of the flesh that You sacrifice on the evening of the first day remain all night until morning.
- 5 *Thou mayest not sacrifice the passover within any of thy gates, which the LORD thy God giveth thee:* You may not offer the Passover sacrifice within any of Your towns that the LORD Your God is giving You,

- 6 *But at the place which the LORD thy God shall choose to place his name in, there thou shalt sacrifice the passover at even, at the going down of the sun, at the season that thou camest forth out of Egypt.* but at the place that the LORD Your God will choose, to make His name dwell in it, there You shall offer the Passover sacrifice, in the evening at sunset, at the time You came out of Egypt.
- 7 *And thou shalt roast and eat it in the place which the LORD thy God shall choose: and thou shalt turn in the morning, and go unto thy tents.* you shall cook it and eat it at the place that the LORD Your God will choose. And in the morning You shall turn and go to Your tents.
- 8 *Six days thou shalt eat unleavened bread: and on the seventh day shall be a solemn assembly to the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work therein.* For six days You shall eat unleavened bread, and on the seventh day there shall be a solemn assembly to the LORD Your God. You shall do no work on it.
- 9 *Seven weeks shalt thou number unto thee: begin to number the seven weeks from such time as thou beginnest to put the sickle to the corn.* You shall count seven weeks. Begin to count the seven weeks from the time the sickle is first put to the standing grain.
- 10 *And thou shalt keep the feast of weeks unto the LORD thy God with a tribute of a freewill offering of thine hand, which thou shalt give unto the LORD thy God, according as the LORD thy God hath blessed thee:* Then You shall keep the Feast of Weeks to the LORD Your God with the tribute of a freewill offering from Your hand, which You shall give as the LORD Your God blesses You.
- 11 *And thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates, and the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, that are among you, in the place which the LORD thy God hath chosen to place his name there.* you shall rejoice before the LORD Your God, You and Your son and Your daughter, Your male servant and Your female servant, the Levite who is within Your towns, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow who are among You, at the place that the LORD Your God will choose, to make His name dwell there.

- 12 *And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in Egypt: and thou shalt observe and do these statutes.* You shall remember that You were a slave in Egypt. You shall be careful to observe these statutes.
- 13 *Thou shalt observe the feast of tabernacles seven days, after that thou hast gathered in thy corn and thy wine:* You shall keep the feast of tabernacles seven days, when You have gathered in the produce from Your threshing floor and Your winepress.
- 14 *And thou shalt rejoice in thy feast, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite, the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, that are within thy gates.* You shall rejoice in Your feast, You and Your son and Your daughter, Your male servant and Your female servant, the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow who are within Your towns.
- 15 *Seven days shalt thou keep a solemn feast unto the LORD thy God in the place which the LORD shall choose: because the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thine increase, and in all the works of thine hands, therefore thou shalt surely rejoice.* For seven days You shall keep the feast to the LORD Your God at the place that the LORD will choose, because the LORD Your God will bless You in all Your produce and in all the work of Your hands, so that You will be altogether joyful.
- 16 *Three times in a year shall all thy males appear before the LORD thy God in the place which he shall choose; in the feast of unleavened bread, and in the feast of weeks, and in the feast of tabernacles: and they shall not appear before the LORD empty:* Three times a year all Your males shall appear before the LORD Your God at the place that He will choose: at the feast of unleavened bread, at the feast of weeks, and at the feast of tabernacles. They shall not appear before the LORD empty-handed.
- 17 *Every man shall give as he is able, according to the blessing of the LORD thy God which he hath given thee.* Every man shall give as he is able, according to the blessing of the LORD Your God that He has given You.

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| <p>18 <i>Judges and officers shalt thou make thee in all thy gates, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, throughout thy tribes: and they shall judge the people with just judgment.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Thou shalt not wrest judgment; thou shalt not respect persons, neither take a gift: for a gift doth blind the eyes of the wise, and pervert the words of the righteous.</i></p> <p>20 <i>That which is altogether just shalt thou follow, that thou mayest live, and inherit the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Thou shalt not plant thee a grove of any trees near unto the altar of the LORD thy God, which thou shalt make thee.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Neither shalt thou set thee up any image; which the LORD thy God hateth.</i></p> | <p>You shall appoint judges and officers in all Your towns that the LORD Your God is giving You, throughout Your tribes. They shall judge the people with righteous judgment.</p> <p>You shall not pervert justice. You shall not show partiality, and You shall not accept a bribe, for a bribe blinds the eyes of the wise and subverts the cause of the righteous.</p> <p>Justice, and only justice, You shall follow, that You may live and inherit the land that the LORD Your God is giving You.</p> <p>You shall not plant any tree as a grove beside the altar of the LORD Your God that You shall make.</p> <p>you shall not set up a pillar, which the LORD Your God hates.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Feast of Tabernacles — Also called the Feast of Booths — a seven-day harvest festival where Israel lived in temporary shelters, remembering the wilderness wandering.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 34:18; Ex 12:2-20; Ex 13:4; Num 28:16; Lev 23:5
- v3 — Ex 12:39
- v4 — Ex 12:10; Ex 34:25
- v9 — Ex 23:16; Ex 34:22; Acts 2:1
- v11 — Deut 12:12; Deut 12:7
- v13 — Ex 23:16; John 7:2
- v16 — Ps 96:8; Prov 3:9-10; Hag 1:9; Ex 23:14-17; Matt 2:11
- v17 — 2 Cor 9:6-7; 2 Cor 8:12; Deut 16:10; Mark 12:41-44

v19 — Lev 19:15; Ex 23:2; Prov 17:23; Deut 24:17; Deut 10:17

v20 — Phil 4:8

v21 — 2 Chr 33:3; 2 Kgs 17:16

v22 — Lev 26:1

Chapter 17

Moses gives laws concerning idolaters who are to be executed on the testimony of two or three witnesses, and difficult legal cases that must be referred to the Levitical priests. He gives instructions for the future king of Israel, who must not multiply horses, wives, or wealth, and must write a copy of the law and read it all his days.

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| <p>¹ <i>Thou shalt not sacrifice unto the LORD thy God any bullock, or sheep, wherein is blemish, or any evilfavouredness: for that is an abomination unto the LORD thy God.</i></p> | <p>You shall not sacrifice to the LORD Your God an ox or a sheep in which is a blemish, any defect whatever, for that is an abomination to the LORD Your God.</p> |
| <p>² <i>If there be found among you, within any of thy gates which the LORD thy God giveth thee, man or woman, that hath wrought wickedness in the sight of the LORD thy God, in transgressing his covenant,</i></p> | <p>If there is found among You, within any of Your towns that the LORD Your God is giving You, a man or woman who does what is evil in the sight of the LORD Your God, in transgressing His covenant,</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And hath gone and served other gods, and worshipped them, either the sun, or moon, or any of the host of heaven, which I have not commanded;</i></p> | <p>has gone and served other gods and worshiped them, or the sun or the moon or any of the host of heaven, which I have forbidden,</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>And it be told thee, and thou hast heard of it, and enquired diligently, and, behold, it be true, and the thing certain, that such abomination is wrought in Israel:</i></p> | <p>it is told You and You hear of it, then You shall inquire diligently, and if it is true and certain that such an abomination has been done in Israel,</p> |
| <p>⁵ <i>Then shalt thou bring forth that man or that woman, which have committed that wicked thing, unto thy gates, even that man or that woman, and shalt stone them with stones, till they die.</i></p> | <p>then You shall bring out to Your gates that man or woman who has done this evil thing, and You shall stone that man or woman to death with stones.</p> |

- 6 *At the mouth of two witnesses, or three witnesses, shall he that is worthy of death be put to death; but at the mouth of one witness he shall not be put to death.* On the evidence of two witnesses or of three witnesses the one who is to die shall be put to death; a person shall not be put to death on the evidence of one witness.
- 7 *The hands of the witnesses shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterward the hands of all the people. So thou shalt put the evil away from among you.* The hand of the witnesses shall be first against Him to put Him to death, and afterward the hand of all the people. So you shall purge the evil from your midst.
- 8 *If there arise a matter too hard for thee in judgment, between blood and blood, between plea and plea, and between stroke and stroke, being matters of controversy within thy gates: then shalt thou arise, and get thee up into the place which the LORD thy God shall choose;* If any case arises requiring a decision between one kind of homicide and another, one kind of legal right and another, or one kind of assault and another, any case within Your towns that is too difficult for You, then You shall arise and go up to the place that the LORD Your God will choose.
- 9 *And thou shalt come unto the priests the Levites, and unto the judge that shall be in those days, and enquire; and they shall shew thee the sentence of judgment:* you shall come to the Levitical priests and to the judge who is in office in those days, and You shall consult them. They shall declare to You the decision.
- 10 *And thou shalt do according to the sentence, which they of that place which the LORD shall choose shall shew thee; and thou shalt observe to do according to all that they inform thee:* Then You shall do according to what they declare to You from that place that the LORD will choose. And You shall be careful to do according to all that they direct You.

- 11 *According to the sentence of the law which they shall teach thee, and according to the judgment which they shall tell thee, thou shalt do: thou shalt not decline from the sentence which they shall shew thee, to the right hand, nor to the left.* According to the instructions that they give You, and according to the decision that they pronounce to You, You shall do. You shall not turn aside from the verdict that they declare to You, either to the right hand or to the left.
- 12 *And the man that will do presumptuously, and will not hearken unto the priest that standeth to minister there before the LORD thy God, or unto the judge, even that man shall die: and thou shalt put away the evil from Israel.* The man who acts presumptuously by not obeying the priest who stands to minister there before the LORD Your God, or the judge, that man shall die. So you shall purge the evil from Israel.
- 13 *And all the people shall hear, and fear, and do no more presumptuously.* all the people shall hear and fear and not act presumptuously again.
- 14 *When thou art come unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, and shalt possess it, and shalt dwell therein, and shalt say, I will set a king over me, like as all the nations that are about me;* When You come to the land that the LORD Your God is giving You, and You possess it and dwell in it and then say, "I will set a king over me, like all the nations that are around me,"
- 15 *Thou shalt in any wise set him king over thee, whom the LORD thy God shall choose: one from among thy brethren shalt thou set king over thee: thou mayest not set a stranger over thee, which is not thy brother.* you may indeed set a king over You whom the LORD Your God will choose. One from among Your brothers You shall set as king over You. You may not put a foreigner over You, who is not Your brother.
- 16 *But he shall not multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt, to the end that he should multiply horses: forasmuch as the LORD hath said unto you, Ye shall henceforth return no more that way.* Only He must not acquire many horses for Himself or cause the people to return to Egypt in order to acquire many horses, since the LORD has said to You, "You shall never return that way again."

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| <p>17 <i>Neither shall he multiply wives to himself, that his heart turn not away: neither shall he greatly multiply to himself silver and gold.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And it shall be, when he sitteth upon the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book out of that which is before the priests the Levites:</i></p> <p>19 <i>And it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life: that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them:</i></p> <p>20 <i>That his heart be not lifted up above his brethren, and that he turn not aside from the commandment, to the right hand, or to the left: to the end that he may prolong his days in his kingdom, he, and his children, in the midst of Israel.</i></p> | <p>he shall not acquire many wives for Himself, lest His heart turn away, nor shall He acquire for Himself excessive silver and gold.</p> <p>when He sits on the throne of His kingdom, He shall write for Himself in a book a copy of this law, approved by the Levitical priests.</p> <p>it shall be with Him. He shall read in it all the days of His life, that He may learn to fear the LORD His God by keeping all the words of this law and these statutes, and doing them,</p> <p>that His heart may not be lifted up above His brothers, and that He may not turn aside from the commandment, either to the right hand or to the left, so that He may continue long in His kingdom, He and His children, in Israel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Deut 15:21
v5 — Lev 24:14
v6 — Heb 10:28; Num 35:30; 1 Tim 5:19; Deut 19:15; Matt 18:16
v7 — Deut 13:9; 1 Cor 5:13
v8 — Deut 12:5
v9 — Ezek 44:24
v14 — 1 Sam 8:19-20
v15 — Jer 30:21; 1 Chr 22:10
v16 — Isa 31:1-3; Ezek 17:15; Deut 28:68; Ps 20:7; Hos 11:5
v17 — Neh 13:26; Prov 30:8-9; Matt 19:5; 1 Kgs 11:1-4; Ps 62:10
v19 — Josh 1:8; Ps 119:97-100; Ps 1:2; 2 Tim 3:15-17; John 5:39

v20 — Deut 5:32; 1 Kgs 15:5

Chapter 18

Moses restates the provision for the Levitical priests, who have no inheritance but live from the offerings. He forbids all forms of divination, sorcery, and consulting familiar spirits, and promises that the LORD will raise up a Prophet like Moses from among their brothers whom they shall hear.

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| <p>1 <i>The priests the Levites, and all the tribe of Levi, shall have no part nor inheritance with Israel: they shall eat the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and his inheritance.</i></p> | <p>The Levitical priests, all the tribe of Levi, shall have no portion or inheritance with Israel. They shall eat the LORD's offerings made by fire as their inheritance.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Therefore shall they have no inheritance among their brethren: the LORD is their inheritance, as he hath said unto them.</i></p> | <p>They shall have no inheritance among their brothers; the LORD is their inheritance, as He promised them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And this shall be the priest's due from the people, from them that offer a sacrifice, whether it be ox or sheep; and they shall give unto the priest the shoulder, and the two cheeks, and the maw.</i></p> | <p>this shall be the priests' due from the people, from those offering a sacrifice, whether an ox or a sheep: they shall give to the priest the shoulder and the two cheeks and the stomach.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The firstfruit also of thy corn, of thy wine, and of thine oil, and the first of the fleece of thy sheep, shalt thou give him.</i></p> | <p>The firstfruits of your grain, of your wine and of your oil, and the first fleece of your sheep, you shall give him.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For the LORD thy God hath chosen him out of all thy tribes, to stand to minister in the name of the LORD, him and his sons for ever.</i></p> | <p>For the LORD Your God has chosen Him out of all Your tribes to stand and minister in the name of the LORD, Him and His sons forever.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And if a Levite come from any of thy gates out of all Israel, where he sojourned, and come with all the desire of his mind unto the place which the LORD shall choose;</i></p> | <p>if a Levite comes from any of Your towns out of all Israel, where He lives—and He may come when He desires—to the place that the LORD will choose,</p> |

- 7 *Then he shall minister in the name of the LORD his God, as all his brethren the Levites do, which stand there before the LORD.* then He may minister in the name of the LORD His God, like all His fellow Levites who stand to minister there before the LORD.
- 8 *They shall have like portions to eat, beside that which cometh of the sale of his patrimony.* They shall have equal portions to eat, besides what He receives from the sale of His patrimony.
- 9 *When thou art come into the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, thou shalt not learn to do after the abominations of those nations.* When You come into the land that the LORD Your God is giving You, You shall not learn to follow the abominable practices of those nations.
- 10 *There shall not be found among you any one that maketh his son or his daughter to pass through the fire, or that useth divination, or an observer of times, or an enchanter, or a witch,* There shall not be found among You anyone who burns his son or his daughter as an offering, anyone who practices divination or tells fortunes or interprets omens, or a sorcerer
- 11 *Or a charmer, or a consulter with familiar spirits, or a wizard, or a necromancer.* or a charmer, or a consulter with familiar spirits, or a wizard, or a necromancer.
- 12 *For all that do these things are an abomination unto the LORD: and because of these abominations the LORD thy God doth drive them out from before thee.* for whoever does these things is an abomination to the LORD. And because of these abominations the LORD Your God is driving them out before You.
- 13 *Thou shalt be perfect with the LORD thy God.* You shall be blameless before the LORD Your God,
- 14 *For these nations, which thou shalt possess, hearkened unto observers of times, and unto diviners: but as for thee, the LORD thy God hath not suffered thee so to do.* for these nations, which You are about to dispossess, listen to fortune-tellers and to diviners. But as for You, the LORD Your God has not allowed You to do this.

- 15 *The LORD thy God will raise up unto thee a Prophet from the midst of thee, of thy brethren, like unto me; unto him ye shall hearken;* The LORD Your God will raise up for You a Prophet like me from among You, from Your brothers—it is to Him You shall listen—
- 16 *According to all that thou desiredst of the LORD thy God in Horeb in the day of the assembly, saying, Let me not hear again the voice of the LORD my God, neither let me see this great fire any more, that I die not.* just as You desired of the LORD Your God at Horeb on the day of the assembly, when You said, "Let me not hear again the voice of the LORD my God or see this great fire any more, lest I die."
- 17 *And the LORD said unto me, They have well spoken that which they have spoken.* the LORD said to me, "They are right in what they have spoken.
- 18 *I will raise them up a Prophet from among their brethren, like unto thee, and will put my words in his mouth; and he shall speak unto them all that I shall command him.* I will raise up for them a Prophet like You from among their brothers. And I will put my words in His mouth. He shall speak to them all that I command Him.
- 19 *And it shall come to pass, that whosoever will not hearken unto my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him.* whoever will not listen to my words that he shall speak in my name, I myself will require it of Him.
- 20 *But the prophet, which shall presume to speak a word in my name, which I have not commanded him to speak, or that shall speak in the name of other gods, even that prophet shall die.* But the prophet who presumes to speak a word in my name that I have not commanded him to speak, or who speaks in the name of other gods, that same prophet shall die."
- 21 *And if thou say in thine heart, How shall we know the word which the LORD hath not spoken?* if You say in Your heart, "How may we know the word that the LORD has not spoken?"—

- 22 *When a prophet speaketh in the name of the LORD, if the thing follow not, nor come to pass, that is the thing which the LORD hath not spoken, but the prophet hath spoken it presumptuously: thou shalt not be afraid of him.* when a prophet speaks in the name of the LORD, if the word does not come to pass or come true, that is a word that the LORD has not spoken; the prophet has spoken it presumptuously. You need not be afraid of Him.

Words in this chapter:

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 10:9; Num 18:8-9; 1 Cor 9:13-14
 v9 — Deut 12:29-31; Lev 18:26-27; Lev 18:30
 v10 — Lev 19:31; Ex 22:18; Lev 19:26; Deut 12:31; Acts 19:19
 v11 — Lev 19:31; 1 Sam 28:11-14
 v12 — Lev 18:24; Deut 9:4; Lev 18:27
 v13 — Matt 5:48; Gen 17:1; Gen 6:9
 v15 — Acts 3:22-23; Acts 7:37; John 1:45; Deut 18:18-19; Luke 9:35
 v16 — Ex 20:19; Deut 9:10; Deut 5:23-28
 v18 — John 12:49-50; Deut 18:15; John 8:28; John 4:25; Luke 24:19
 v19 — Acts 3:22-23; Heb 2:3
 v20 — Jer 27:15; Deut 13:1-5; Ezek 13:6; Zech 13:3; Matt 7:15
 v22 — Deut 18:20; 2 Kgs 20:1; Jer 28:1-17

Chapter 19

Moses gives the law of the cities of refuge for those who kill unintentionally, and commands that three cities be set aside in the Promised Land with three more added if the LORD enlarges their territory. He gives the law requiring two or three witnesses for any charge, with false witnesses receiving the punishment they intended for the accused.

- 1 *When the LORD thy God hath cut off the nations, whose land the LORD thy God giveth thee, and thou succeedest them, and dwellest in their cities, and in their houses;* When the LORD Your God cuts off the nations whose land the LORD Your God is giving You, and You dispossess them and dwell in their cities and in their houses,

- 2 *Thou shalt separate three cities for thee in the midst of thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it.* you shall set apart three cities for yourselves in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You to possess.
- 3 *Thou shalt prepare thee a way, and divide the coasts of thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee to inherit, into three parts, that every slayer may flee thither.* You shall measure the distances and divide into three parts the area of the land that the LORD Your God gives You as a possession, so that any manslayer can flee to them.
- 4 *And this is the case of the slayer, which shall flee thither, that he may live: Whoso killeth his neighbour ignorantly, whom he hated not in time past;* This is the provision for the manslayer, who by fleeing there may save His life. If anyone kills his neighbor unintentionally without having hated Him in the past—
- 5 *As when a man goeth into the wood with his neighbour to hew wood, and his hand fetcheth a stroke with the axe to cut down the tree, and the head slippeth from the helve, and lighteth upon his neighbour, that he die; he shall flee unto one of those cities, and live;* as when someone goes into the forest with his neighbor to cut wood. His hand swings the axe to cut down a tree, and the head slips from the handle and strikes His neighbor so that He dies—he may flee to one of these cities and live,
- 6 *Lest the avenger of the blood pursue the slayer, while his heart is hot, and overtake him, because the way is long, and slay him; whereas he was not worthy of death, inasmuch as he hated him not in time past.* lest the avenger of blood in hot anger pursue the manslayer and overtake him, because the way is long, and strike him fatally, though the man did not deserve to die, since he had not hated his neighbor in the past.
- 7 *Wherefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt separate three cities for thee.* Therefore I command you, "You shall set apart three cities."

- 8 *And if the LORD thy God enlarge thy coast, as he hath sworn unto thy fathers, and give thee all the land which he promised to give unto thy fathers;* if the LORD Your God enlarges Your territory, as He has sworn to Your fathers, and gives You all the land that He promised to give to Your fathers—
- 9 *If thou shalt keep all these commandments to do them, which I command thee this day, to love the LORD thy God, and to walk ever in his ways; then shalt thou add three cities more for thee, beside these three:* provided You are careful to keep all this commandment that I command You today, by loving the LORD Your God and by walking ever in His ways—then You shall add three other cities to these three,
- 10 *That innocent blood be not shed in thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance, and so blood be upon thee.* lest innocent blood be shed in Your land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance, and so the guilt of bloodshed be upon You.
- 11 *But if any man hate his neighbour, and lie in wait for him, and rise up against him, and smite him mortally that he die, and fleeth into one of these cities:* But if anyone hates his neighbor and lies in wait for him and attacks Him and strikes Him fatally so that He dies, and He flees into one of these cities,
- 12 *Then the elders of his city shall send and fetch him thence, and deliver him into the hand of the avenger of blood, that he may die.* then the elders of His city shall send and take Him from there, and hand Him over to the avenger of blood, so that He may die.
- 13 *Thine eye shall not pity him, but thou shalt put away the guilt of innocent blood from Israel, that it may go well with thee.* Your eye shall not pity Him, but You shall purge the guilt of innocent blood from Israel, so that it may be well with You.
- 14 *Thou shalt not remove thy neighbour's landmark, which they of old time have set in thine inheritance, which thou shalt inherit in the land that the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it.* You shall not move Your neighbor's landmark, which the men of old have set, in the inheritance that You will hold in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You to possess.

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| <p>15 <i>One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin, in any sin that he sinneth: at the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall the matter be established.</i></p> | <p>A single witness shall not suffice against a person for any crime or for any wrong in connection with any offense that He has committed. Only on the evidence of two witnesses or of three witnesses shall a charge be established.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>If a false witness rise up against any man to testify against him that which is wrong;</i></p> | <p>If a malicious witness arises to accuse a person of wrongdoing,</p> |
| <p>17 <i>Then both the men, between whom the controversy is, shall stand before the LORD, before the priests and the judges, which shall be in those days;</i></p> | <p>then both parties to the dispute shall appear before the LORD, before the priests and the judges who are in office in those days.</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And the judges shall make diligent inquisition: and, behold, if the witness be a false witness, and hath testified falsely against his brother;</i></p> | <p>The judges shall inquire diligently, and if the witness is a false witness and has accused His brother falsely,</p> |
| <p>19 <i>Then shall ye do unto him, as he had thought to have done unto his brother: so shalt thou put the evil away from among you.</i></p> | <p>then You shall do to Him as He had meant to do to His brother. So You shall purge the evil from Your midst.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And those which remain shall hear, and fear, and shall henceforth commit no more any such evil among you.</i></p> | <p>the rest shall hear and fear, and shall never again commit any such evil among You.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>And thine eye shall not pity; but life shall go for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.</i></p> | <p>Your eye shall not pity. It shall be life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 12:29

v4 — Num 35:15-24

v13 — 1 Kgs 2:31; Deut 21:9; Deut 7:16; Deut 7:2

v14 — Prov 22:28; Deut 27:17

v15 — Num 35:30; Deut 17:6; 2 Cor 13:1; Heb 10:28; Matt 18:16

v16 — Ps 27:12

v17 — Deut 17:9; Deut 21:5; Mal 2:7

v19 — Prov 19:5; Prov 19:9

v21 — Matt 5:38-39; Ex 21:23-25; Deut 19:13

Chapter 20

Moses gives the laws of warfare. The priests are to encourage the army before battle, and officers are to send home anyone who has built a new house, planted a vineyard, betrothed a wife, or is afraid. When besieging a city, Israel is to offer peace first; distant cities that refuse are put to the sword, but the seven nations of Canaan are to be utterly destroyed.

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| <p>1 <i>When thou goest out to battle against thine enemies, and seest horses, and chariots, and a people more than thou, be not afraid of them: for the LORD thy God is with thee, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.</i></p> | <p>When You go out to war against Your enemies, and see horses and chariots and an army larger than Your own, You shall not be afraid of them, for the LORD Your God is with You, who brought You up out of the land of Egypt.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it shall be, when ye are come nigh unto the battle, that the priest shall approach and speak unto the people,</i></p> | <p>when you draw near to the battle, the priest shall come forward and speak to the people</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And shall say unto them, Hear, O Israel, ye approach this day unto battle against your enemies: let not your hearts faint, fear not, and do not tremble, neither be ye terrified because of them;</i></p> | <p>shall say to them, "Hear, O Israel, today you are drawing near for battle against your enemies: let not your heart faint. Do not fear or panic or be in dread of them,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For the LORD your God is he that goeth with you, to fight for you against your enemies, to save you.</i></p> | <p>for the LORD Your God is He who goes with you to fight for you against your enemies, to give You the victory."</p> |

- 5 *And the officers shall speak unto the people, saying, What man is there that hath built a new house, and hath not dedicated it? let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man dedicate it.* Then the officers shall speak to the people, saying, "Is there any man who has built a new house and has not dedicated it? Let Him go back to His house, lest He die in the battle and another man dedicate it.
- 6 *And what man is he that hath planted a vineyard, and hath not yet eaten of it? let him also go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man eat of it.* is there any man who has planted a vineyard and has not yet enjoyed its fruit? Let Him go back to His house, lest He die in the battle and another man enjoy its fruit.
- 7 *And what man is there that hath betrothed a wife, and hath not taken her? let him go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man take her.* is there any man who has betrothed a wife and has not taken her? Let Him go back to His house, lest He die in the battle and another man take her."
- 8 *And the officers shall speak further unto the people, and they shall say, What man is there that is fearful and fainthearted? let him go and return unto his house, lest his brethren's heart faint as well as his heart.* the officers shall speak further to the people, and say, "Is there any man who is fearful and fainthearted? Let Him go back to His house, lest He make the heart of His fellows melt like His own."
- 9 *And it shall be, when the officers have made an end of speaking unto the people, that they shall make captains of the armies to lead the people.* when the officers have finished speaking to the people, then commanders shall be appointed at the head of the people.
- 10 *When thou comest nigh unto a city to fight against it, then proclaim peace unto it.* When You draw near to a city to fight against it, offer terms of peace to it.
- 11 *And it shall be, if it make thee answer of peace, and open unto thee, then it shall be, that all the people that is found therein shall be tributaries unto thee, and they shall serve thee.* if it responds to You peaceably and it opens to You, then all the people who are found in it shall do forced labor for You and shall serve You.

- 12 *And if it will make no peace with thee, but will make war against thee, then thou shalt besiege it:* But if it makes no peace with You, but makes war against You, then You shall besiege it.
- 13 *And when the LORD thy God hath delivered it into thine hands, thou shalt smite every male thereof with the edge of the sword:* when the LORD Your God gives it into Your hand, You shall put all its males to the sword,
- 14 *But the women, and the little ones, and the cattle, and all that is in the city, even all the spoil thereof, shalt thou take unto thyself; and thou shalt eat the spoil of thine enemies, which the LORD thy God hath given thee.* but the women and the little ones, the livestock, and everything else in the city, all its spoil, You shall take as plunder for yourselves. And You shall enjoy the spoil of Your enemies, which the LORD Your God has given You.
- 15 *Thus shalt thou do unto all the cities which are very far off from thee, which are not of the cities of these nations.* Thus You shall do to all the cities that are very far from You, which are not cities of the nations here.
- 16 *But of the cities of these people, which the LORD thy God doth give thee for an inheritance, thou shalt save alive nothing that breatheth:* But in the cities of these peoples that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance, You shall save alive nothing that breathes,
- 17 *But thou shalt utterly destroy them; namely, the Hittites, and the Amorites, the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites; as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee:* but You shall devote them to complete destruction, the Hittites and the Amorites, the Canaanites and the Perizzites, the Hivites and the Jebusites, as the LORD Your God has commanded,
- 18 *That they teach you not to do after all their abominations, which they have done unto their gods; so should ye sin against the LORD your God.* that they may not teach You to do according to all their abominable practices that they have done for their gods, and so You sin against the LORD Your God.

- 19 *When thou shalt besiege a city a long time, in making war against it to take it, thou shalt not destroy the trees thereof by forcing an axe against them: for thou mayest eat of them, and thou shalt not cut them down (for the tree of the field is man's life) to employ them in the siege:* When You besiege a city for a long time, making war against it in order to take it, You shall not destroy its trees by wielding an axe against them. You may eat from them, but You shall not cut them down. Are the trees in the field human, that they should be besieged by You?
- 20 *Only the trees which thou knowest that they be not trees for meat, thou shalt destroy and cut them down; and thou shalt build bulwarks against the city that maketh war with thee, until it be subdued.* Only the trees that You know are not trees for food You may destroy and cut down, that You may build siegeworks against the city that makes war with You, until it falls.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Chr 32:7-8; Deut 31:8; Ps 20:7; Deut 31:6; Rom 8:31

v3 — Ps 3:6; Heb 13:6; Rev 2:10; Josh 23:10; Ps 27:1-3

v4 — Ex 14:14; Deut 3:22; Deut 1:30; Josh 23:10; Deut 11:25

v5 — Neh 12:27

v7 — Deut 24:5

v8 — Judg 7:3; Rev 21:8; Deut 1:28

v14 — Josh 8:2

v16 — Josh 11:14; Num 21:2-3

v18 — Deut 12:30-31; Ex 23:33

v19 — Matt 3:10

Chapter 21

Moses gives laws for unsolved murders, requiring the nearest city's elders to perform a ritual with a heifer. He also gives laws concerning the rights of a wife taken captive in war, the inheritance rights of the firstborn son, and the stoning of a rebellious son.

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| <p>1 <i>If one be found slain in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it, lying in the field, and it be not known who hath slain him:</i></p> | <p>If in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You to possess someone is found slain, lying in the open country, and it is not known who killed Him,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then thy elders and thy judges shall come forth, and they shall measure unto the cities which are round about him that is slain:</i></p> | <p>then Your elders and Your judges shall come out. They shall measure the distance to the surrounding cities.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And it shall be, that the city which is next unto the slain man, even the elders of that city shall take an heifer, which hath not been wrought with, and which hath not drawn in the yoke;</i></p> | <p>the elders of the city that is nearest to the slain man shall take a heifer that has never been worked and that has not pulled in a yoke.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the elders of that city shall bring down the heifer unto a rough valley, which is neither eared nor sown, and shall strike off the heifer's neck there in the valley:</i></p> | <p>the elders of that city shall bring the heifer down to a valley with running water, which is neither plowed nor sown, and shall break the heifer's neck there in the valley.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the priests the sons of Levi shall come near; for them the LORD thy God hath chosen to minister unto him, and to bless in the name of the LORD; and by their word shall every controversy and every stroke be tried:</i></p> | <p>Then the priests, the sons of Levi, shall come forward, for the LORD Your God has chosen them to minister to Him and to bless in the name of the LORD, and by their word every dispute and every assault shall be settled.</p> |

- 6 *And all the elders of that city, that are next unto the slain man, shall wash their hands over the heifer that is beheaded in the valley:* all the elders of that city nearest to the slain man shall wash their hands over the heifer whose neck was broken in the valley,
- 7 *And they shall answer and say, Our hands have not shed this blood, neither have our eyes seen it.* they shall testify, "Our hands did not shed this blood, nor did our eyes see it shed.
- 8 *Be merciful, O LORD, unto thy people Israel, whom thou hast redeemed, and lay not innocent blood unto thy people of Israel's charge. And the blood shall be forgiven them.* Accept atonement, O LORD, for Your people Israel, whom You have redeemed, and do not set the guilt of innocent blood in the midst of Your people Israel, so that their blood guilt be atoned for."
- 9 *So shalt thou put away the guilt of innocent blood from among you, when thou shalt do that which is right in the sight of the LORD.* So You shall purge the guilt of innocent blood from Your midst, when You do what is right in the sight of the LORD.
- 10 *When thou goest forth to war against thine enemies, and the LORD thy God hath delivered them into thine hands, and thou hast taken them captive,* When You go out to war against Your enemies, and the LORD Your God gives them into Your hands and You take them captive,
- 11 *And seest among the captives a beautiful woman, and hast a desire unto her, that thou wouldest have her to thy wife;* you see among the captives a beautiful woman, and You desire to take her to be Your wife,
- 12 *Then thou shalt bring her home to thine house, and she shall shave her head, and pare her nails;* you bring her home to Your house, she shall shave her head and pare her nails.
- 13 *And she shall put the raiment of her captivity from off her, and shall remain in thine house, and bewail her father and her mother a full month: and after that thou shalt go in unto her, and be her husband, and she shall be thy wife.* she shall take off the clothes she was captured in and shall remain in Your house and lament her father and her mother a full month. After that You may go in to her and be her husband. She shall be Your wife.

- 14 *And it shall be, if thou have no delight in her, then thou shalt let her go whither she will; but thou shalt not sell her at all for money, thou shalt not make merchandise of her, because thou hast humbled her.* But if You no longer delight in her, You shall let her go where she wants. But You shall not sell her for money, nor shall You treat her as a slave, since You have humiliated her.
- 15 *If a man have two wives, one beloved, and another hated, and they have born him children, both the beloved and the hated; and if the firstborn son be hers that was hated:* If a man has two wives, the one loved and the other unloved, and both the loved and the unloved have borne Him children, and if the firstborn son belongs to the unloved,
- 16 *Then it shall be, when he maketh his sons to inherit that which he hath, that he may not make the son of the beloved firstborn before the son of the hated, which is indeed the firstborn:* then on the day when He assigns His possessions as an inheritance to His sons, He may not treat the son of the loved as the firstborn in preference to the son of the unloved, who is the firstborn,
- 17 *But he shall acknowledge the son of the hated for the firstborn, by giving him a double portion of all that he hath: for he is the beginning of his strength; the right of the firstborn is his.* but He shall acknowledge the firstborn, the son of the unloved, by giving Him a double portion of all that He has, for He is the firstfruits of His strength. The right of the firstborn is His.
- 18 *If a man have a stubborn and rebellious son, which will not obey the voice of his father, or the voice of his mother, and that, when they have chastened him, will not hearken unto them:* If a man has a stubborn and rebellious son who will not obey the voice of His father or the voice of His mother, and, though they discipline Him, will not listen to them,
- 19 *Then shall his father and his mother lay hold on him, and bring him out unto the elders of his city, and unto the gate of his place;* then His father and His mother shall take hold of Him and bring Him out to the elders of His city at the gate of the place where He lives,

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| <p>20 <i>And they shall say unto the elders of his city, This our son is stubborn and rebellious, he will not obey our voice; he is a glutton, and a drunkard.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And all the men of his city shall stone him with stones, that he die: so shalt thou put evil away from among you; and all Israel shall hear, and fear.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And if a man have committed a sin worthy of death, and he be to be put to death, and thou hang him on a tree:</i></p> <p>23 <i>His body shall not remain all night upon the tree, but thou shalt in any wise bury him that day; (for he that is hanged is accursed of God;) that thy land be not defiled, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance.</i></p> | <p>they shall say to the elders of His city, "This our son is stubborn and rebellious; He will not obey our voice; He is a glutton and a drunkard."</p> <p>Then all the men of the city shall stone Him to death with stones. So You shall purge the evil from Your midst. All Israel shall hear, and fear.</p> <p>if a man has committed a crime punishable by death and He is put to death, and You hang Him on a tree,</p> <p>his body shall not remain all night on the tree, but You shall bury Him the same day, for a hanged man is cursed by God. You shall not defile Your land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

v5 — 1 Chr 23:13; Mal 2:7; Deut 10:8; Deut 19:17

v14 — Deut 22:29

v15 — Gen 29:33

v17 — Gen 49:3

v18 — Lev 19:3; Ex 20:12

v22 — Acts 26:31; John 19:31-38

v23 — Gal 3:13; John 19:31

Chapter 22

Moses gives laws requiring Israelites to return lost animals and help with fallen beasts of burden. He gives laws against wearing the opposite sex's clothing, taking a mother bird with her young, building a roof parapet, mixing seeds, yoking an ox with a donkey, and mixing fabrics. He also gives laws concerning sexual purity and marriage.

- 1 *Thou shalt not see thy brother's ox or his sheep go astray, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt in any case bring them again unto thy brother.* You shall not see your brother's ox or his sheep going astray and ignore them. You shall take them back to your brother.
- 2 *And if thy brother be not nigh unto thee, or if thou know him not, then thou shalt bring it unto thine own house, and it shall be with thee until thy brother seek after it, and thou shalt restore it to him again.* if he does not live near you and you do not know who he is, you shall bring it home to your house. It shall stay with you until your brother seeks it. Then you shall return it to him.
- 3 *In like manner shalt thou do with his ass; and so shalt thou do with his raiment; and with all lost thing of thy brother's, which he hath lost, and thou hast found, shalt thou do likewise: thou mayest not hide thyself.* you shall do the same with his donkey or with his garment, or with any lost thing of your brother's, which he loses and you find; you may not ignore it.
- 4 *Thou shalt not see thy brother's ass or his ox fall down by the way, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt surely help him to lift them up again.* You shall not see your brother's donkey or his ox fallen down by the way and ignore them. You shall help him to lift them up again.
- 5 *The woman shall not wear that which pertaineth unto a man, neither shall a man put on a woman's garment: for all that do so are abomination unto the LORD thy God.* A woman shall not wear a man's garment, nor shall a man put on a woman's cloak, for whoever does these things is an abomination to the LORD Your God.
- 6 *If a bird's nest chance to be before thee in the way in any tree, or on the ground, whether they be young ones, or eggs, and the dam sitting upon the young, or upon the eggs, thou shalt not take the dam with the young:* If You come across a bird's nest in any tree or on the ground, with young ones or eggs and the mother sitting on the young or on the eggs, You shall not take the mother with the young.

- 7 *But thou shalt in any wise let the dam go, and take the young to thee; that it may be well with thee, and that thou mayest prolong thy days.* You shall let the mother go, but the young You may take for Yourself, that it may go well with You, and that You may live long.
- 8 *When thou buildest a new house, then thou shalt make a battlement for thy roof, that thou bring not blood upon thine house, if any man fall from thence.* When You build a new house, You shall make a parapet for Your roof, that You may not bring the guilt of blood upon Your house, if anyone should fall from it.
- 9 *Thou shalt not sow thy vineyard with divers seeds: lest the fruit of thy seed which thou hast sown, and the fruit of thy vineyard, be defiled.* You shall not sow Your vineyard with two kinds of seed, lest the whole yield be forfeited, the crop that You have sown and the yield of the vineyard.
- 10 *Thou shalt not plow with an ox and an ass together.* You shall not plow with an ox and a donkey together.
- 11 *Thou shalt not wear a garment of divers sorts, as of woollen and linen together.* You shall not wear cloth of wool and linen mixed together.
- 12 *Thou shalt make thee fringes upon the four quarters of thy vesture, wherewith thou coverest thyself.* You shall make Yourself tassels on the four corners of the garment with which You cover Yourself.
- 13 *If any man take a wife, and go in unto her, and hate her,* If any man takes a wife and goes in to her and then hates her
- 14 *And give occasions of speech against her, and bring up an evil name upon her, and say, I took this woman, and when I came to her, I found her not a maid:* accuses her of misconduct and brings a bad name upon her, saying, "I took this woman, and when I came near her, I did not find in her evidence of virginity,"
- 15 *Then shall the father of the damsel, and her mother, take and bring forth the tokens of the damsel's virginity unto the elders of the city in the gate:* then the father of the young woman and her mother shall take and bring out the evidence of her virginity to the elders of the city in the gate.

- 16 *And the damsel's father shall say unto the elders, I gave my daughter unto this man to wife, and he hateth her;* the father of the young woman shall say to the elders, "I gave my daughter to this man to marry. He hates her;
- 17 *And, lo, he hath given occasions of speech against her, saying, I found not thy daughter a maid; and yet these are the tokens of my daughter's virginity. And they shall spread the cloth before the elders of the city.* now he has accused her of misconduct, saying, 'I did not find in your daughter evidence of virginity.' And yet this is the evidence of my daughter's virginity." And they shall spread the cloth before the elders of the city.
- 18 *And the elders of that city shall take that man and chastise him;* Then the elders of that city shall take the man and punish him.
- 19 *And they shall amerce him in an hundred shekels of silver, and give them unto the father of the damsel, because he hath brought up an evil name upon a virgin of Israel: and she shall be his wife; he may not put her away all his days.* they shall fine him a hundred shekels of silver and give them to the father of the young woman, because he has brought a bad name upon a virgin of Israel. And she shall be his wife. He may not divorce her all his days.
- 20 *But if this thing be true, and the tokens of virginity be not found for the damsel:* But if the thing is true, that evidence of virginity was not found in the young woman,
- 21 *Then they shall bring out the damsel to the door of her father's house, and the men of her city shall stone her with stones that she die: because she hath wrought folly in Israel, to play the whore in her father's house: so shalt thou put evil away from among you.* then they shall bring out the young woman to the door of her father's house, and the men of her city shall stone her to death with stones, because she has done an outrageous thing in Israel by whoring in her father's house. So you shall purge the evil from your midst.
- 22 *If a man be found lying with a woman married to an husband, then they shall both of them die, both the man that lay with the woman, and the woman: so shalt thou put away evil from Israel.* If a man is found lying with the wife of another man, both of them shall die, the man who lay with the woman, and the woman. So you shall purge the evil from Israel.

- 23 *If a damsel that is a virgin be betrothed unto an husband, and a man find her in the city, and lie with her;* If there is a betrothed virgin, and a man meets her in the city and lies with her,
- 24 *Then ye shall bring them both out unto the gate of that city, and ye shall stone them with stones that they die; the damsel, because she cried not, being in the city; and the man, because he hath humbled his neighbour's wife: so thou shalt put away evil from among you.* then you shall bring them both out to the gate of that city, and you shall stone them to death with stones, the young woman because she did not cry for help though she was in the city, and the man because he violated his neighbor's wife. So you shall purge the evil from your midst.
- 25 *But if a man find a betrothed damsel in the field, and the man force her, and lie with her: then the man only that lay with her shall die:* But if in the open country a man meets a young woman who is betrothed, and the man seizes her and lies with her, then only the man who lay with her shall die.
- 26 *But unto the damsel thou shalt do nothing; there is in the damsel no sin worthy of death: for as when a man riseth against his neighbour, and slayeth him, even so is this matter:* But you shall do nothing to the young woman; she has committed no offense punishable by death. For this case is like that of a man attacking and murdering his neighbor,
- 27 *For he found her in the field, and the betrothed damsel cried, and there was none to save her.* because he met her in the open country, and though the betrothed young woman cried for help there was no one to rescue her.
- 28 *If a man find a damsel that is a virgin, which is not betrothed, and lay hold on her, and lie with her, and they be found;* If a man meets a virgin who is not betrothed, and seizes her and lies with her, and they are found,
- 29 *Then the man that lay with her shall give unto the damsel's father fifty shekels of silver, and she shall be his wife; because he hath humbled her, he may not put her away all his days.* then the man who lay with her shall give to the young woman's father fifty shekels of silver. She shall be his wife, because he has violated her. He may not divorce her all his days.

- 30 *A man shall not take his father's wife, nor discover his father's skirt.* A man shall not take his father's wife, so that he does not uncover his father's nakedness.
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Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v5 — 1 Cor 11:4-15; Deut 18:12
 v6 — Lev 22:28
 v7 — Deut 4:40
 v9 — Lev 19:19
 v10 — 2 Cor 6:14-16
 v11 — Lev 19:19
 v12 — Matt 23:5
 v21 — Gen 34:7; Deut 13:5
 v22 — Lev 20:10
 v28 — Ex 22:16-17
 v29 — Deut 22:19
 v30 — Deut 27:20; 1 Cor 5:1; Lev 18:8; Lev 20:11

Chapter 23

Moses gives laws about who may and may not enter the assembly of the LORD. He gives regulations for the cleanliness of the military camp, the protection of escaped slaves, the prohibition of prostitution, restrictions on charging interest to fellow Israelites, and the keeping of vows.

- 1 *He that is wounded in the stones, or hath his privy member cut off, shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD.* No one whose testicles are crushed or whose male organ is cut off shall enter the assembly of the LORD.
- 2 *A bastard shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to his tenth generation shall he not enter into the congregation of the LORD.* No one born of a forbidden union may enter the assembly of the LORD. Even to the tenth generation, none of His descendants may enter the assembly of the LORD.

- 3 *An Ammonite or Moabite shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to their tenth generation shall they not enter into the congregation of the LORD for ever:* No Ammonite or Moabite may enter the assembly of the LORD. Even to the tenth generation, none of them may enter the assembly of the LORD forever,
- 4 *Because they met you not with bread and with water in the way, when ye came forth out of Egypt; and because they hired against thee Balaam the son of Beor of Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse thee.* because they did not meet You with bread and with water on the way, when You came out of Egypt, and because they hired against You Balaam the son of Beor from Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse You.
- 5 *Nevertheless the LORD thy God would not hearken unto Balaam; but the LORD thy God turned the curse into a blessing unto thee, because the LORD thy God loved thee.* But the LORD Your God would not listen to Balaam; instead the LORD Your God turned the curse into a blessing for You, because the LORD Your God loved You.
- 6 *Thou shalt not seek their peace nor their prosperity all thy days for ever.* You shall not seek their peace or their prosperity all Your days forever.
- 7 *Thou shalt not abhor an Edomite; for he is thy brother: thou shalt not abhor an Egyptian; because thou wast a stranger in his land.* You shall not abhor an Edomite, for He is Your brother. You shall not abhor an Egyptian, because You were a sojourner in His land.
- 8 *The children that are begotten of them shall enter into the congregation of the LORD in their third generation.* Children born to them in the third generation may enter the assembly of the LORD.
- 9 *When the host goeth forth against thine enemies, then keep thee from every wicked thing.* When You are encamped against Your enemies, You shall keep Yourself from every evil thing.
- 10 *If there be among you any man, that is not clean by reason of uncleanness that chanceth him by night, then shall he go abroad out of the camp, he shall not come within the camp:* If any man among You becomes unclean because of a nocturnal emission, then He shall go outside the camp. He shall not come inside the camp.

- 11 *But it shall be, when evening cometh on, he shall wash himself with water: and when the sun is down, he shall come into the camp again.* But when evening comes, He shall bathe Himself in water, and when the sun has set, He may come inside the camp.
- 12 *Thou shalt have a place also without the camp, whither thou shalt go forth abroad:* You shall have a place outside the camp, and You shall go out to it.
- 13 *And thou shalt have a paddle upon thy weapon; and it shall be, when thou wilt ease thyself abroad, thou shalt dig therewith, and shalt turn back and cover that which cometh from thee:* you shall have a trowel with Your tools, and when You sit down outside, You shall dig a hole with it and turn back and cover up Your excrement.
- 14 *For the LORD thy God walketh in the midst of thy camp, to deliver thee, and to give up thine enemies before thee; therefore shall thy camp be holy: that he see no unclean thing in thee, and turn away from thee.* Because the LORD Your God walks in the midst of Your camp, to deliver You and to give up Your enemies before You, therefore Your camp must be holy, so that He may not see anything indecent among You and turn away from You.
- 15 *Thou shalt not deliver unto his master the servant which is escaped from his master unto thee:* You shall not give up to His master a slave who has escaped from His master to You.
- 16 *He shall dwell with thee, even among you, in that place which he shall choose in one of thy gates, where it liketh him best: thou shalt not oppress him.* He shall dwell with You, in Your midst, in the place that He shall choose within one of Your towns, wherever it suits Him best. You shall not wrong Him.
- 17 *There shall be no whore of the daughters of Israel, nor a sodomite of the sons of Israel.* None of the daughters of Israel shall be a cult prostitute, and none of the sons of Israel shall be a cult prostitute.

- 18 *Thou shalt not bring the hire of a whore, or the price of a dog, into the house of the LORD thy God for any vow: for even both these are abomination unto the LORD thy God.* You shall not bring the fee of a prostitute or the wages of a male prostitute into the house of the LORD Your God in payment for any vow, for both of these are an abomination to the LORD Your God.
- 19 *Thou shalt not lend upon usury to thy brother; usury of money, usury of victuals, usury of any thing that is lent upon usury:* You shall not charge interest on loans to Your brother, interest on money, interest on food, interest on anything that is lent for interest.
- 20 *Unto a stranger thou mayest lend upon usury; but unto thy brother thou shalt not lend upon usury: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all that thou settest thine hand to in the land whither thou goest to possess it.* You may charge a foreigner interest, but You may not charge Your brother interest, that the LORD Your God may bless You in all that You undertake in the land that You are entering to take possession of it.
- 21 *When thou shalt vow a vow unto the LORD thy God, thou shalt not slack to pay it: for the LORD thy God will surely require it of thee; and it would be sin in thee.* If You make a vow to the LORD Your God, You shall not delay fulfilling it, for the LORD Your God will surely require it of You, and You will be guilty of sin.
- 22 *But if thou shalt forbear to vow, it shall be no sin in thee.* But if You refrain from vowing, You will not be guilty of sin.
- 23 *That which is gone out of thy lips thou shalt keep and perform; even a freewill offering, according as thou hast vowed unto the LORD thy God, which thou hast promised with thy mouth.* You shall be careful to do what has passed Your lips, for You have voluntarily vowed to the LORD Your God what You have promised with Your mouth.
- 24 *When thou comest into thy neighbour's vineyard, then thou mayest eat grapes thy fill at thine own pleasure; but thou shalt not put any in thy vessel.* If You go into Your neighbor's vineyard, You may eat Your fill of grapes, as many as You wish, but You shall not put any in Your bag.

- 25 *When thou comest into the standing corn of thy neighbour, then thou mayest pluck the ears with thine hand; but thou shalt not move a sickle unto thy neighbour's standing corn.* If You go into Your neighbor's standing grain, You may pluck the ears with Your hand, but You shall not put a sickle to Your neighbor's standing grain.

Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

victuals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gal 3:28; Isa 56:3-4
- v2 — Zech 9:6; Isa 57:3
- v3 — Neh 13:1-2
- v4 — Neh 13:2; 2 Pet 2:15
- v5 — Deut 7:7-8; Rom 8:31; Num 24:9; Eph 2:4-5; 2 Cor 4:17
- v6 — Ezra 9:12
- v7 — Deut 10:19; Ex 22:21; Ex 23:9; Lev 19:34
- v14 — Lev 26:12; Gen 17:1; 2 Cor 6:16; Ex 3:5
- v15 — 1 Sam 30:15
- v17 — 2 Kgs 23:7; 1 Kgs 14:24; Lev 19:29; Deut 22:21; 1 Kgs 22:46
- v21 — Eccl 5:4-5; Ps 66:13-14; Ps 116:18; Ps 56:12; Num 30:1-16
- v25 — Matt 12:1-2; Mark 2:23

Chapter 24

Moses gives laws concerning divorce and remarriage, the exemption of a newly married man from military service, and the prohibition of taking millstones as a pledge. He gives laws protecting hired servants, forbidding the punishment of children for their fathers' sins, and requiring that the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow receive gleanings from the harvest.

- 1 *When a man hath taken a wife, and married her, and it come to pass that she find no favour in his eyes, because he hath found some uncleanness in her: then let him write her a bill of divorcement, and give it in her hand, and send her out of his house.*

When a man takes a wife and marries her, if then she finds no favor in his eyes because he has found some indecency in her, then let him write her a certificate of divorce and put it in her hand and send her out of his house,
- 2 *And when she is departed out of his house, she may go and be another man's wife.*

she departs out of his house, and if she goes and becomes another man's wife,
- 3 *And if the latter husband hate her, and write her a bill of divorcement, and giveth it in her hand, and sendeth her out of his house; or if the latter husband die, which took her to be his wife;*

the latter man hates her and writes her a certificate of divorce and puts it in her hand and sends her out of his house, or if the latter man dies, who took her to be his wife,
- 4 *Her former husband, which sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife, after that she is defiled; for that is abomination before the LORD: and thou shalt not cause the land to sin, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance.*

then her former husband, who sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife, after she has been defiled, for that is an abomination before the LORD. And You shall not bring sin upon the land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance.
- 5 *When a man hath taken a new wife, he shall not go out to war, neither shall he be charged with any business: but he shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer up his wife which he hath taken.*

When a man is newly married, he shall not go out with the army or be liable for any other public duty. He shall be free at home one year to be happy with his wife whom He has taken.
- 6 *No man shall take the nether or the upper millstone to pledge: for he taketh a man's life to pledge.*

No one shall take a mill or an upper millstone in pledge, for that would be taking a life in pledge.

- 7 *If a man be found stealing any of his brethren of the children of Israel, and maketh merchandise of him, or selleth him; then that thief shall die; and thou shalt put evil away from among you.* If a man is found stealing one of his brothers of the people of Israel, and if he treats him as a slave or sells Him, then that thief shall die. So You shall purge the evil from Your midst.
- 8 *Take heed in the plague of leprosy, that thou observe diligently, and do according to all that the priests the Levites shall teach you: as I commanded them, so ye shall observe to do.* Take care, in a case of a skin disease, to be very careful to do according to all that the Levitical priests shall direct You. As I commanded them, so You shall be careful to do.
- 9 *Remember what the LORD thy God did unto Miriam by the way, after that ye were come forth out of Egypt.* Remember what the LORD Your God did to Miriam on the way as You came out of Egypt.
- 10 *When thou dost lend thy brother any thing, thou shalt not go into his house to fetch his pledge.* When You make Your neighbor a loan of any sort, You shall not go into His house to collect His pledge.
- 11 *Thou shalt stand abroad, and the man to whom thou dost lend shall bring out the pledge abroad unto thee.* You shall stand outside, and the man to whom you make the loan shall bring the pledge out to you.
- 12 *And if the man be poor, thou shalt not sleep with his pledge:* if he is a poor man, you shall not sleep in his pledge.
- 13 *In any case thou shalt deliver him the pledge again when the sun goeth down, that he may sleep in his own raiment, and bless thee: and it shall be righteousness unto thee before the LORD thy God.* You shall restore to Him the pledge as the sun sets, that He may sleep in His cloak and bless You. And it shall be righteousness for You before the LORD Your God.
- 14 *Thou shalt not oppress an hired servant that is poor and needy, whether he be of thy brethren, or of thy strangers that are in thy land within thy gates:* You shall not oppress a hired worker who is poor and needy, whether He is one of Your brothers or one of the foreigners who are in Your land within Your towns.

- 15 *At his day thou shalt give him his hire, neither shall the sun go down upon it; for he is poor, and setteth his heart upon it: lest he cry against thee unto the LORD, and it be sin unto thee.* You shall give Him His wages on the same day, before the sun sets (for He is poor and counts on it), lest He cry against You to the LORD, and You be guilty of sin.
- 16 *The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers: every man shall be put to death for his own sin.* Fathers shall not be put to death because of their children, nor shall children be put to death because of their fathers. Each one shall be put to death for his own sin.
- 17 *Thou shalt not pervert the judgment of the stranger, nor of the fatherless; nor take a widow's raiment to pledge:* You shall not pervert the justice due to the sojourner or to the fatherless, or take a widow's garment in pledge,
- 18 *But thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in Egypt, and the LORD thy God redeemed thee thence: therefore I command thee to do this thing.* but You shall remember that You were a slave in Egypt and the LORD Your God redeemed You from there; therefore I command You to do this.
- 19 *When thou cuttest down thine harvest in thy field, and hast forgot a sheaf in the field, thou shalt not go again to fetch it: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hands.* When You reap Your harvest in Your field and forget a sheaf in the field, You shall not go back to get it. It shall be for the sojourner, the fatherless, and the widow, that the LORD Your God may bless You in all the work of Your hands.
- 20 *When thou beatest thine olive tree, thou shalt not go over the boughs again: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.* When You beat Your olive trees, You shall not go over them again. It shall be for the sojourner, the fatherless, and the widow.
- 21 *When thou gatherest the grapes of thy vineyard, thou shalt not glean it afterward: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.* When You gather the grapes of Your vineyard, You shall not strip it afterward. It shall be for the sojourner, the fatherless, and the widow.

- 22

And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in the land of Egypt: therefore I command thee to do this thing.
- You shall remember that You were a slave in the land of Egypt; therefore I command You to do this.

Words in this chapter:

Miriam (*MEER-ee-am*) — Moses and Aaron's older sister — led the women in song after the Red Sea crossing; later struck with leprosy for challenging Moses's authority.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 19:7-9; Deut 22:13; Mark 10:4-12; Isa 50:1
- v4** — Jer 3:1
- v5** — Prov 5:18; Deut 20:7; Gen 2:24; Titus 2:4-5; Mark 10:6-9
- v7** — Ex 21:16
- v9** — Num 12:10-15; 1 Cor 10:11
- v13** — Dan 4:27; Deut 6:25
- v14** — Mal 3:5; Prov 14:31; Prov 22:16; Amos 4:1; Job 24:10-11
- v15** — Lev 19:13; Prov 3:27-28; Jas 5:4; Jer 22:13; Deut 15:9
- v16** — Ezek 18:20; 2 Chr 25:4; Jer 31:29-30; 2 Kgs 14:5-6
- v17** — Deut 16:19
- v18** — Deut 5:15
- v19** — Lev 23:22; Lev 19:9-10; Deut 14:29; Prov 19:17; Isa 58:7-11

Chapter 25

Moses limits flogging to forty stripes, commands that the ox not be muzzled while treading grain, and gives the law of levirate marriage requiring a brother to marry his deceased brother's widow. He commands Israel to remember what Amalek did to them and to blot out their memory from under heaven.

- 1

If there be a controversy between men, and they come unto judgment, that the judges may judge them; then they shall justify the righteous, and condemn the wicked.
- If there is a dispute between men and they come into court and the judges decide between them, acquitting the innocent and condemning the guilty,
- 2

And it shall be, if the wicked man be worthy to be beaten, that the judge shall cause him to lie down, and to be beaten before his face, according to his fault, by a certain number.
- then if the guilty man deserves to be beaten, the judge shall cause him to lie down and be beaten in his presence with a number of stripes in proportion to his offense.

- 3 *Forty stripes he may give him, and not exceed: lest, if he should exceed, and beat him above these with many stripes, then thy brother should seem vile unto thee.* Forty stripes may be given him, but not more, lest, if one should go on to beat him with more stripes than these, your brother be degraded in your sight.
- 4 *Thou shalt not muzzle the ox when he treadeth out the corn.* You shall not muzzle an ox when it is treading out the grain.
- 5 *If brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband's brother shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband's brother unto her.* If brothers dwell together, and one of them dies and has no son, the wife of the dead man shall not be married outside the family to a stranger. Her husband's brother shall go in to her and take her as his wife and perform the duty of a husband's brother to her.
- 6 *And it shall be, that the firstborn which she beareth shall succeed in the name of his brother which is dead, that his name be not put out of Israel.* the first son whom she bears shall succeed to the name of his dead brother, that his name may not be blotted out of Israel.
- 7 *And if the man like not to take his brother's wife, then let his brother's wife go up to the gate unto the elders, and say, My husband's brother refuseth to raise up unto his brother a name in Israel, he will not perform the duty of my husband's brother.* if the man does not wish to take his brother's wife, then his brother's wife shall go up to the gate to the elders and say, "My husband's brother refuses to perpetuate his brother's name in Israel; he will not perform the duty of a husband's brother to me."
- 8 *Then the elders of his city shall call him, and speak unto him: and if he stand to it, and say, I like not to take her;* Then the elders of his city shall call him and speak to him, and if he persists, saying, "I do not wish to take her,"

- 9 *Then shall his brother's wife come unto him in the presence of the elders, and loose his shoe from off his foot, and spit in his face, and shall answer and say, So shall it be done unto that man that will not build up his brother's house.* then his brother's wife shall go up to him in the presence of the elders and pull his sandal off his foot and spit in his face. And she shall answer and say, "So shall it be done to the man who does not build up his brother's house."
- 10 *And his name shall be called in Israel, The house of him that hath his shoe loosed.* the name of his house shall be called in Israel, "The house of him whose sandal was pulled off."
- 11 *When men strive together one with another, and the wife of the one draweth near for to deliver her husband out of the hand of him that smiteth him, and putteth forth her hand, and taketh him by the secrets:* When men fight with one another and the wife of the one draws near to rescue her husband from the hand of him who is beating him and puts out her hand and seizes him by the private parts,
- 12 *Then thou shalt cut off her hand, thine eye shall not pity her.* then you shall cut off her hand. Your eye shall have no pity.
- 13 *Thou shalt not have in thy bag divers weights, a great and a small.* You shall not have in your bag two kinds of weights, a large and a small.
- 14 *Thou shalt not have in thine house divers measures, a great and a small.* You shall not have in your house two kinds of measures, a large and a small.
- 15 *But thou shalt have a perfect and just weight, a perfect and just measure shalt thou have: that thy days may be lengthened in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.* A full and fair weight You shall have, a full and fair measure You shall have, that Your days may be long in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You.
- 16 *For all that do such things, and all that do unrighteously, are an abomination unto the LORD thy God.* For all who do such things, all who act dishonestly, are an abomination to the LORD Your God.
- 17 *Remember what Amalek did unto thee by the way, when ye were come forth out of Egypt;* Remember what Amalek did to You on the way as You came out of Egypt,

- 18 *How he met thee by the way, and smote the hindmost of thee, even all that were feeble behind thee, when thou wast faint and weary; and he feared not God.* how He attacked You on the way when You were faint and weary, and cut off Your tail, those who were lagging behind You. He did not fear God.
- 19 *Therefore it shall be, when the LORD thy God hath given thee rest from all thine enemies round about, in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance to possess it, that thou shalt blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven; thou shalt not forget it.* Therefore when the LORD Your God has given You rest from all Your enemies around You, in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance to possess, You shall blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven; You shall not forget.

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v4** — 1 Tim 5:17-18; 1 Cor 9:9-10
v5 — Luke 20:28; Matt 22:24; Mark 12:19; Gen 38:8-9; Ruth 1:12-13
v8 — Ruth 4:6
v9 — Ruth 4:7-8; Num 12:14
v12 — Deut 19:13
v16 — Prov 11:1; Rev 21:27
v17 — Ex 17:8-16
v18 — Ps 36:1; Rom 3:18

Chapter 26

Moses commands Israel to bring the firstfruits of the land to the priest and recite a confession recounting their history from Jacob to the exodus. He also commands the third-year tithe for the Levite, stranger, fatherless, and widow, and declares that Israel and the LORD have mutually pledged themselves to each other.

- 1 *And it shall be, when thou art come in unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance, and possessest it, and dwellest therein;* when You come into the land that the LORD Your God is giving You for an inheritance and have taken possession of it and live in it,
- 2 *That thou shalt take of the first of all the fruit of the earth, which thou shalt bring of thy land that the LORD thy God giveth thee, and shalt put it in a basket, and shalt go unto the place which the LORD thy God shall choose to place his name there.* you shall take some of the first of all the fruit of the ground, which You harvest from Your land that the LORD Your God is giving You, and You shall put it in a basket, and You shall go to the place that the LORD Your God will choose, to make His name dwell there.
- 3 *And thou shalt go unto the priest that shall be in those days, and say unto him, I profess this day unto the LORD thy God, that I am come unto the country which the LORD sware unto our fathers for to give us.* you shall go to the priest who is in office at that time and say to Him, "I declare today to the LORD Your God that I have come into the land that the LORD swore to our fathers to give us."
- 4 *And the priest shall take the basket out of thine hand, and set it down before the altar of the LORD thy God.* Then the priest shall take the basket from your hand and set it down before the altar of the LORD Your God.
- 5 *And thou shalt speak and say before the LORD thy God, A Syrian ready to perish was my father, and he went down into Egypt, and sojourned there with a few, and became there a nation, great, mighty, and populous:* you shall make response before the LORD Your God, "A wandering Aramean was my father. And He went down into Egypt and stayed there, few in number, and there He became a nation, great, mighty, and populous.
- 6 *And the Egyptians evil entreated us, and afflicted us, and laid upon us hard bondage:* the Egyptians treated us harshly and humiliated us and laid on us hard labor.

- 7 *And when we cried unto the LORD God of our fathers, the LORD heard our voice, and looked on our affliction, and our labour, and our oppression:* Then we cried to the LORD, the God of our fathers. The LORD heard our voice and saw our affliction, our toil, and our oppression.
- 8 *And the LORD brought us forth out of Egypt with a mighty hand, and with an outstretched arm, and with great terribleness, and with signs, and with wonders:* the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm, with great deeds of terror, with signs and wonders.
- 9 *And he hath brought us into this place, and hath given us this land, even a land that floweth with milk and honey.* he brought us into this place and gave us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 10 *And now, behold, I have brought the firstfruits of the land, which thou, O LORD, hast given me. And thou shalt set it before the LORD thy God, and worship before the LORD thy God:* now, see, I bring the first of the fruit of the ground, which You, O LORD, have given me." And You shall set it down before the LORD Your God and worship before the LORD Your God.
- 11 *And thou shalt rejoice in every good thing which the LORD thy God hath given unto thee, and unto thine house, thou, and the Levite, and the stranger that is among you.* you shall rejoice in all the good that the LORD Your God has given to You and to Your house, You, and the Levite, and the stranger who is among You.
- 12 *When thou hast made an end of tithing all the tithes of thine increase the third year, which is the year of tithing, and hast given it unto the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, that they may eat within thy gates, and be filled;* When You have finished paying all the tithe of Your produce in the third year, which is the year of tithing, giving it to the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, so that they may eat within Your towns and be filled,

- 13 *Then thou shalt say before the LORD thy God, I have brought away the hallowed things out of mine house, and also have given them unto the Levite, and unto the stranger, to the fatherless, and to the widow, according to all thy commandments which thou hast commanded me: I have not transgressed thy commandments, neither have I forgotten them:* then You shall say before the LORD Your God, "I have removed the sacred portion out of my house, and moreover, I have given it to the Levite, the sojourner, the fatherless, and the widow, according to all Your commandment that You have commanded me. I have not transgressed any of Your commandments, nor have I forgotten them.
- 14 *I have not eaten thereof in my mourning, neither have I taken away ought thereof for any unclean use, nor given ought thereof for the dead: but I have hearkened to the voice of the LORD my God, and have done according to all that thou hast commanded me.* I have not eaten of the tithe while I was mourning, or removed any of it while I was unclean, or offered any of it to the dead. I have obeyed the voice of the LORD my God. I have done according to all that You have commanded me.
- 15 *Look down from thy holy habitation, from heaven, and bless thy people Israel, and the land which thou hast given us, as thou swarest unto our fathers, a land that floweth with milk and honey.* Look down from Your holy habitation, from heaven, and bless Your people Israel and the ground that You have given us, as You swore to our fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey."
- 16 *This day the LORD thy God hath commanded thee to do these statutes and judgments: thou shalt therefore keep and do them with all thine heart, and with all thy soul.* This day the LORD Your God commands You to do these statutes and rules. You shall therefore be careful to do them with all Your heart and with all Your soul.
- 17 *Thou hast avouched the LORD this day to be thy God, and to walk in his ways, and to keep his statutes, and his commandments, and his judgments, and to hearken unto his voice:* You have declared today that the LORD is Your God, and that You will walk in His ways, and keep His statutes and His commandments and His rules, and will obey His voice.

- 18 *And the LORD hath avouched thee this day to be his peculiar people, as he hath promised thee, and that thou shouldest keep all his commandments;* the LORD has declared today that You are a people for His treasured possession, as He has promised You, and that You are to keep all His commandments,
- 19 *And to make thee high above all nations which he hath made, in praise, and in name, and in honour; and that thou mayest be an holy people unto the LORD thy God, as he hath spoken.* that He will set You in praise and in fame and in honor high above all nations that He has made, and that You shall be a people holy to the LORD Your God, as He promised.
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Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Ex 23:19; Ex 23:16
v5 — Deut 10:22; Gen 46:27; Gen 43:1-2; Gen 31:20; Gen 31:24
v6 — Ex 1:11
v8 — Deut 4:34
v11 — Deut 16:11; Deut 12:7
v12 — Num 18:24; Lev 27:30
v13 — Ps 119:141; Ps 119:176; Ps 119:153
v14 — Lev 7:20; Hos 9:4; Lev 21:11; Lev 21:1
v15 — Isa 63:15; Zech 2:13
v17 — Isa 12:2; Ex 24:7
v18 — Deut 14:2; Deut 28:9; Deut 7:6; Titus 2:14; Ex 6:7
v19 — 1 Pet 2:9; Deut 28:1; Deut 7:6; Deut 4:7-8; Ex 19:6

Chapter 27

Moses and the elders command Israel to set up large plastered stones on Mount Ebal when they cross the Jordan and write the words of the law on them. Six tribes are to stand on Mount Gerizim to bless and six on Mount Ebal to curse, and the Levites pronounce twelve curses for specific sins, to which the people answer 'Amen.'

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| <p>1 <i>And Moses with the elders of Israel commanded the people, saying, Keep all the commandments which I command you this day.</i></p> | <p>Now Moses and the elders of Israel commanded the people, saying, "Keep the whole commandment that I command you today.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it shall be on the day when ye shall pass over Jordan unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, that thou shalt set thee up great stones, and plaister them with plaister:</i></p> | <p>on the day You cross over the Jordan to the land that the LORD Your God is giving You, You shall set up large stones and plaster them with plaster.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And thou shalt write upon them all the words of this law, when thou art passed over, that thou mayest go in unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, a land that floweth with milk and honey; as the LORD God of thy fathers hath promised thee.</i></p> | <p>you shall write on them all the words of this law, when You cross over to enter the land that the LORD Your God is giving You, a land flowing with milk and honey, as the LORD, the God of Your fathers, has promised You.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Therefore it shall be when ye be gone over Jordan, that ye shall set up these stones, which I command you this day, in mount Ebal, and thou shalt plaister them with plaister.</i></p> | <p>when You have crossed over the Jordan, You shall set up these stones, concerning which I command You today, on Mount Ebal, and You shall plaster them with plaster.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And there shalt thou build an altar unto the LORD thy God, an altar of stones: thou shalt not lift up any iron tool upon them.</i></p> | <p>there You shall build an altar to the LORD Your God, an altar of stones. You shall wield no iron tool on them.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Thou shalt build the altar of the LORD thy God of whole stones: and thou shalt offer burnt offerings thereon unto the LORD thy God:</i></p> | <p>You shall build the altar of the LORD Your God of uncut stones, and You shall offer burnt offerings on it to the LORD Your God,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And thou shalt offer peace offerings, and shalt eat there, and rejoice before the LORD thy God.</i></p> | <p>you shall sacrifice peace offerings and shall eat there, and You shall rejoice before the LORD Your God.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And thou shalt write upon the stones all the words of this law very plainly.</i></p> | <p>you shall write on the stones all the words of this law very plainly."</p> |

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| <p>9 <i>And Moses and the priests the Levites spake unto all Israel, saying, Take heed, and hearken, O Israel; this day thou art become the people of the LORD thy God.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Thou shalt therefore obey the voice of the LORD thy God, and do his commandments and his statutes, which I command thee this day.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Moses charged the people the same day, saying,</i></p> <p>12 <i>These shall stand upon mount Gerizim to bless the people, when ye are come over Jordan; Simeon, and Levi, and Judah, and Issachar, and Joseph, and Benjamin:</i></p> <p>13 <i>And these shall stand upon mount Ebal to curse; Reuben, Gad, and Asher, and Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the Levites shall speak, and say unto all the men of Israel with a loud voice,</i></p> <p>15 <i>Cursed be the man that maketh any graven or molten image, an abomination unto the LORD, the work of the hands of the craftsman, and putteth it in a secret place. And all the people shall answer and say, Amen.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Cursed be he that setteth light by his father or his mother. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i></p> | <p>Then Moses and the Levitical priests said to all Israel, "Keep silence and hear, O Israel: this day you have become the people of the LORD your God.</p> <p>You shall therefore obey the voice of the LORD Your God, keeping His commandments and His statutes, which I command You today."</p> <p>Moses charged the people the same day, saying,</p> <p>"When you have crossed over the Jordan, these shall stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin.</p> <p>these shall stand on Mount Ebal for the curse: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali.</p> <p>the Levites shall declare to all the men of Israel in a loud voice:</p> <p>"Cursed be the man who makes a carved or cast metal image, an abomination to the LORD, a thing made by the hands of a craftsman, and sets it up in secret." And all the people shall answer and say, "Amen."</p> <p>"Cursed be anyone who dishonors his father or his mother." And all the people shall say, "Amen."</p> |
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| 17 <i>Cursed be he that removeth his neighbour's landmark. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who moves his neighbor's landmark." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 18 <i>Cursed be he that maketh the blind to wander out of the way. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who misleads a blind man on the road." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 19 <i>Cursed be he that perverteth the judgment of the stranger, fatherless, and widow. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who perverts the justice due to the sojourner, the fatherless, and the widow." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 20 <i>Cursed be he that lieth with his father's wife; because he uncovereth his father's skirt. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who lies with his father's wife, because he has uncovered His father's nakedness." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 21 <i>Cursed be he that lieth with any manner of beast. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who lies with any kind of animal." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 22 <i>Cursed be he that lieth with his sister, the daughter of his father, or the daughter of his mother. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who lies with his sister, whether the daughter of His father or the daughter of His mother." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 23 <i>Cursed be he that lieth with his mother in law. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who lies with his mother-in-law." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 24 <i>Cursed be he that smiteth his neighbour secretly. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who strikes down his neighbor in secret." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 25 <i>Cursed be he that taketh reward to slay an innocent person. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who takes a bribe to shed innocent blood." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |
| 26 <i>Cursed be he that confirmeth not all the words of this law to do them. And all the people shall say, Amen.</i> | "Cursed be anyone who does not confirm the words of this law by doing them." And all the people shall say, "Amen." |

Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

v3 — Josh 8:32

v5 — Ex 20:25

v8 — Hab 2:2

v10 — 1 Pet 1:14-16; Deut 11:1

v15 — Ex 34:17; Ex 20:4; Deut 5:8; Lev 26:1; Lev 19:4

v16 — Lev 19:3; Ex 21:17

v17 — Deut 19:14

v18 — Lev 19:14

v19 — Deut 10:18; Deut 24:17; Ps 82:2-4; Ex 22:21-24; Ex 23:2

v20 — Deut 22:30

v22 — Lev 18:9; Lev 20:17

v26 — Gal 3:10; Deut 28:15-68

Chapter 28

Moses pronounces blessings for obedience -- prosperity, victory, and honor among the nations -- and curses for disobedience -- disease, drought, defeat, madness, and exile. The curses grow in severity, climaxing in siege, cannibalism, and the scattering of Israel among all nations from one end of the earth to the other.

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | <i>And it shall come to pass, if thou shalt hearken diligently unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe and to do all his commandments which I command thee this day, that the LORD thy God will set thee on high above all nations of the earth:</i> | if You faithfully obey the voice of the LORD Your God, being careful to do all His commandments that I command You today, the LORD Your God will set You high above all the nations of the earth. |
| 2 | <i>And all these blessings shall come on thee, and overtake thee, if thou shalt hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God.</i> | all these blessings shall come upon You and overtake You, if You obey the voice of the LORD Your God. |
| 3 | <i>Blessed shalt thou be in the city, and blessed shalt thou be in the field.</i> | Blessed shall You be in the city, and blessed shall You be in the field. |
| 4 | <i>Blessed shall be the fruit of thy body, and the fruit of thy ground, and the fruit of thy cattle, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep.</i> | Blessed shall be the fruit of Your womb and the fruit of Your ground and the fruit of Your cattle, the increase of Your herds and the young of Your flock. |
| 5 | <i>Blessed shall be thy basket and thy store.</i> | Blessed shall be Your basket and Your kneading bowl. |
| 6 | <i>Blessed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and blessed shalt thou be when thou goest out.</i> | Blessed shall You be when You come in, and blessed shall You be when You go out. |
| 7 | <i>The LORD shall cause thine enemies that rise up against thee to be smitten before thy face: they shall come out against thee one way, and flee before thee seven ways.</i> | The LORD will cause Your enemies who rise against You to be defeated before You. They shall come out against You one way and flee before You seven ways. |
| 8 | <i>The LORD shall command the blessing upon thee in thy storehouses, and in all that thou settest thine hand unto; and he shall bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.</i> | The LORD will command the blessing on You in Your barns and in all that You undertake. And He will bless You in the land that the LORD Your God is giving You. |

- 9 *The LORD shall establish thee an holy people unto himself, as he hath sworn unto thee, if thou shalt keep the commandments of the LORD thy God, and walk in his ways.* The LORD will establish You as a people holy to Himself, as He has sworn to You, if You keep the commandments of the LORD Your God and walk in His ways.
- 10 *And all people of the earth shall see that thou art called by the name of the LORD; and they shall be afraid of thee.* all the peoples of the earth shall see that You are called by the name of the LORD. They shall be afraid of You.
- 11 *And the LORD shall make thee plenteous in goods, in the fruit of thy body, and in the fruit of thy cattle, and in the fruit of thy ground, in the land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers to give thee.* the LORD will make You abound in prosperity, in the fruit of Your womb and in the fruit of Your livestock and in the fruit of Your ground, within the land that the LORD swore to Your fathers to give You.
- 12 *The LORD shall open unto thee his good treasure, the heaven to give the rain unto thy land in his season, and to bless all the work of thine hand: and thou shalt lend unto many nations, and thou shalt not borrow.* The LORD will open to You His good treasury, the heavens, to give the rain to Your land in its season and to bless all the work of Your hands. And You shall lend to many nations, but You shall not borrow.
- 13 *And the LORD shall make thee the head, and not the tail; and thou shalt be above only, and thou shalt not be beneath; if that thou hearken unto the commandments of the LORD thy God, which I command thee this day, to observe and to do them:* the LORD will make You the head and not the tail, and You shall only go up and not down, if You obey the commandments of the LORD Your God, which I command You today, being careful to do them,
- 14 *And thou shalt not go aside from any of the words which I command thee this day, to the right hand, or to the left, to go after other gods to serve them.* if You do not turn aside from any of the words that I command You today, to the right hand or to the left, to go after other gods to serve them.

- 15 *But it shall come to pass, if thou wilt not hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe to do all his commandments and his statutes which I command thee this day; that all these curses shall come upon thee, and overtake thee:* But if You will not obey the voice of the LORD Your God or be careful to do all His commandments and His statutes that I command You today, then all these curses shall come upon You and overtake You.
- 16 *Cursed shalt thou be in the city, and cursed shalt thou be in the field.* Cursed shall You be in the city, and cursed shall You be in the field.
- 17 *Cursed shall be thy basket and thy store.* Cursed shall be Your basket and Your kneading bowl.
- 18 *Cursed shall be the fruit of thy body, and the fruit of thy land, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep.* Cursed shall be the fruit of Your womb and the fruit of Your ground, the increase of Your herds and the young of Your flock.
- 19 *Cursed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and cursed shalt thou be when thou goest out.* Cursed shall You be when You come in, and cursed shall You be when You go out.
- 20 *The LORD shall send upon thee cursing, vexation, and rebuke, in all that thou settest thine hand unto for to do, until thou be destroyed, and until thou perish quickly; because of the wickedness of thy doings, whereby thou hast forsaken me.* The LORD will send on You curses, confusion, and frustration in all that You undertake to do, until You are destroyed and perish quickly on account of the evil of Your deeds, because You have forsaken me.
- 21 *The LORD shall make the pestilence cleave unto thee, until he have consumed thee from off the land, whither thou goest to possess it.* The LORD will make the pestilence stick to You until He has consumed You off the land that You are entering to take possession of it.

- 22 *The LORD shall smite thee with a consumption, and with a fever, and with an inflammation, and with an extreme burning, and with the sword, and with blasting, and with mildew; and they shall pursue thee until thou perish.* The LORD will strike You with wasting disease and with fever, inflammation and fiery heat, and with drought and with blight and with mildew. They shall pursue You until You perish.
- 23 *And thy heaven that is over thy head shall be brass, and the earth that is under thee shall be iron.* the heavens over Your head shall be bronze, and the earth under You shall be iron.
- 24 *The LORD shall make the rain of thy land powder and dust: from heaven shall it come down upon thee, until thou be destroyed.* The LORD will make the rain of Your land powder and dust. From heaven it shall come down on You until You are destroyed.
- 25 *The LORD shall cause thee to be smitten before thine enemies: thou shalt go out one way against them, and flee seven ways before them: and shalt be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth.* The LORD will cause You to be defeated before Your enemies. You shall go out one way against them and flee seven ways before them. And You shall be a horror to all the kingdoms of the earth.
- 26 *And thy carcase shall be meat unto all fowls of the air, and unto the beasts of the earth, and no man shall fray them away.* your dead body shall be food for all birds of the air and for the beasts of the earth, and there shall be no one to frighten them away.
- 27 *The LORD will smite thee with the botch of Egypt, and with the emerods, and with the scab, and with the itch, whereof thou canst not be healed.* The LORD will strike You with the boils of Egypt, and with tumors and scabs and itch, of which You cannot be healed.
- 28 *The LORD shall smite thee with madness, and blindness, and astonishment of heart:* The LORD will strike You with madness and blindness and confusion of mind,

- 29 *And thou shalt grope at noonday, as the blind gropeth in darkness, and thou shalt not prosper in thy ways: and thou shalt be only oppressed and spoiled evermore, and no man shall save thee.* you shall grope at noonday, as the blind grope in darkness, and You shall not prosper in Your ways. And You shall be only oppressed and robbed continually, and there shall be no one to help you.
- 30 *Thou shalt betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her: thou shalt build an house, and thou shalt not dwell therein: thou shalt plant a vineyard, and shalt not gather the grapes thereof.* You shall betroth a wife, but another man shall ravish her. You shall build a house, but You shall not dwell in it. You shall plant a vineyard, but You shall not enjoy its fruit.
- 31 *Thine ox shall be slain before thine eyes, and thou shalt not eat thereof: thine ass shall be violently taken away from before thy face, and shall not be restored to thee: thy sheep shall be given unto thine enemies, and thou shalt have none to save thee.* Your ox shall be slaughtered before Your eyes, but You shall not eat any of it. Your donkey shall be seized before Your face and shall not be returned to You. Your sheep shall be given to Your enemies, and there shall be no one to help you.
- 32 *Thy sons and thy daughters shall be given unto another people, and thine eyes shall look, and fail with longing for them all the day long: and there shall be no might in thine hand.* Your sons and Your daughters shall be given to another people, while Your eyes look on and fail with longing for them all day long, but You shall be helpless.
- 33 *The fruit of thy land, and all thy labours, shall a nation which thou knowest not eat up; and thou shalt be only oppressed and crushed alway:* A nation that You have not known shall eat up the fruit of Your ground and of all Your labors, and You shall be only oppressed and crushed continually,
- 34 *So that thou shalt be mad for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.* so that You are driven mad by the sights that Your eyes see.

- 35 *The LORD shall smite thee in the knees, and in the legs, with a sore botch that cannot be healed, from the sole of thy foot unto the top of thy head.* The LORD will strike You on the knees and on the legs with grievous boils of which You cannot be healed, from the sole of Your foot to the crown of Your head.
- 36 *The LORD shall bring thee, and thy king which thou shalt set over thee, unto a nation which neither thou nor thy fathers have known; and there shalt thou serve other gods, wood and stone.* The LORD will bring You and Your king whom You set over You to a nation that neither You nor Your fathers have known. And there You shall serve other gods of wood and stone.
- 37 *And thou shalt become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword, among all nations whither the LORD shall lead thee.* you shall become a horror, a proverb, and a byword among all the peoples where the LORD will lead You away.
- 38 *Thou shalt carry much seed out into the field, and shalt gather but little in; for the locust shall consume it.* You shall carry much seed into the field and shall gather in little, for the locust shall consume it.
- 39 *Thou shalt plant vineyards, and dress them, but shalt neither drink of the wine, nor gather the grapes; for the worms shall eat them.* You shall plant vineyards and dress them, but You shall neither drink of the wine nor gather the grapes, for the worm shall eat them.
- 40 *Thou shalt have olive trees throughout all thy coasts, but thou shalt not anoint thyself with the oil; for thine olive shall cast his fruit.* You shall have olive trees throughout all Your territory, but You shall not anoint Yourself with the oil, for Your olives shall drop off.
- 41 *Thou shalt beget sons and daughters, but thou shalt not enjoy them; for they shall go into captivity.* You shall father sons and daughters. But they shall not be Yours, for they shall go into captivity.
- 42 *All thy trees and fruit of thy land shall the locust consume.* The cricket shall possess all Your trees and the fruit of Your ground.
- 43 *The stranger that is within thee shall get up above thee very high; and thou shalt come down very low.* The sojourner who is among You shall rise higher and higher above You, and You shall come down lower and lower.

- 44 *He shall lend to thee, and thou shalt not lend to him: he shall be the head, and thou shalt be the tail.* He shall lend to You, and You shall not lend to Him. He shall be the head, and You shall be the tail.
- 45 *Moreover all these curses shall come upon thee, and shall pursue thee, and overtake thee, till thou be destroyed; because thou hearkenedst not unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded thee:* All these curses shall come upon You and pursue You and overtake You till You are destroyed, because You did not obey the voice of the LORD Your God, to keep His commandments and His statutes that He commanded You.
- 46 *And they shall be upon thee for a sign and for a wonder, and upon thy seed for ever.* They shall be a sign and a wonder against You and Your seed forever.
- 47 *Because thou servedst not the LORD thy God with joyfulness, and with gladness of heart, for the abundance of all things;* Because You did not serve the LORD Your God with joyfulness and gladness of heart, because of the abundance of all things,
- 48 *Therefore shalt thou serve thine enemies which the LORD shall send against thee, in hunger, and in thirst, and in nakedness, and in want of all things: and he shall put a yoke of iron upon thy neck, until he have destroyed thee.* therefore You shall serve Your enemies whom the LORD will send against You, in hunger and thirst, in nakedness, and lacking everything. And He will put a yoke of iron on Your neck until He has destroyed You.
- 49 *The LORD shall bring a nation against thee from far, from the end of the earth, as swift as the eagle flieth; a nation whose tongue thou shalt not understand;* The LORD will bring a nation against You from far away, from the end of the earth, swooping down like the eagle, a nation whose language You do not understand,
- 50 *A nation of fierce countenance, which shall not regard the person of the old, nor shew favour to the young:* a hard-faced nation who shall not respect the old or show mercy to the young.

- 51 *And he shall eat the fruit of thy cattle, and the fruit of thy land, until thou be destroyed: which also shall not leave thee either corn, wine, or oil, or the increase of thy kine, or flocks of thy sheep, until he have destroyed thee.* It shall eat the seed of Your cattle and the fruit of Your ground, until You are destroyed; it also shall not leave You grain, wine, or oil, the increase of Your herds or the young of Your flock, until they have caused You to perish.
- 52 *And he shall besiege thee in all thy gates, until thy high and fenced walls come down, wherein thou trustedst, throughout all thy land: and he shall besiege thee in all thy gates throughout all thy land, which the LORD thy God hath given thee.* They shall besiege You in all Your towns, until Your high and fortified walls, in which You trusted, come down throughout all Your land. And they shall besiege You in all Your towns throughout all Your land, which the LORD Your God has given You.
- 53 *And thou shalt eat the fruit of thine own body, the flesh of thy sons and of thy daughters, which the LORD thy God hath given thee, in the siege, and in the straitness, wherewith thine enemies shall distress thee:* you shall eat the fruit of Your womb, the flesh of Your sons and daughters, whom the LORD Your God has given You, in the siege and in the distress with which Your enemies shall distress You.
- 54 *So that the man that is tender among you, and very delicate, his eye shall be evil toward his brother, and toward the wife of his bosom, and toward the remnant of his children which he shall leave:* The man who is the most tender and refined among you will begrudge food to his brother, to the wife he embraces, and to the last of the children whom he has left,
- 55 *So that he will not give to any of them of the flesh of his children whom he shall eat: because he hath nothing left him in the siege, and in the straitness, wherewith thine enemies shall distress thee in all thy gates.* so that he will not give to any of them any of the flesh of his children whom he is eating, because he has nothing else left, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy shall distress you in all your towns.

- 56 *The tender and delicate woman among you, which would not adventure to set the sole of her foot upon the ground for delicateness and tenderness, her eye shall be evil toward the husband of her bosom, and toward her son, and toward her daughter,* The most tender and refined woman among you, who would not venture to set the sole of her foot on the ground because she is so delicate and tender, will begrudge to the husband she embraces, to her son and to her daughter,
- 57 *And toward her young one that cometh out from between her feet, and toward her children which she shall bear: for she shall eat them for want of all things secretly in the siege and straitness, wherewith thine enemy shall distress thee in thy gates.* her afterbirth that comes out from between her feet and her children whom she bears, because lacking everything she will eat them secretly, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy shall distress you in your towns.
- 58 *If thou wilt not observe to do all the words of this law that are written in this book, that thou mayest fear this glorious and fearful name, THE LORD THY GOD;* If You are not careful to do all the words of this law that are written in this book, that You may fear this glorious and awesome name, the LORD Your God,
- 59 *Then the LORD will make thy plagues wonderful, and the plagues of thy seed, even great plagues, and of long continuance, and sore sicknesses, and of long continuance.* then the LORD will bring on You and Your seed extraordinary afflictions, afflictions severe and lasting, and sicknesses grievous and lasting.
- 60 *Moreover he will bring upon thee all the diseases of Egypt, which thou wast afraid of; and they shall cleave unto thee.* he will bring upon You again all the diseases of Egypt, of which You were afraid. They shall cling to You.
- 61 *Also every sickness, and every plague, which is not written in the book of this law, them will the LORD bring upon thee, until thou be destroyed.* Every sickness also and every affliction that is not recorded in the book of this law, the LORD will bring upon You, until You are destroyed.

- 62 *And ye shall be left few in number, whereas ye were as the stars of heaven for multitude; because thou wouldst not obey the voice of the LORD thy God.* Whereas You were as numerous as the stars of heaven, You shall be left few in number, because You did not obey the voice of the LORD Your God.
- 63 *And it shall come to pass, that as the LORD rejoiced over you to do you good, and to multiply you; so the LORD will rejoice over you to destroy you, and to bring you to nought; and ye shall be plucked from off the land whither thou goest to possess it.* as the LORD took delight in doing You good and multiplying You, so the LORD will take delight in bringing ruin upon You and destroying You. And You shall be plucked off the land that You are entering to take possession of it.
- 64 *And the LORD shall scatter thee among all people, from the one end of the earth even unto the other; and there thou shalt serve other gods, which neither thou nor thy fathers have known, even wood and stone.* the LORD will scatter You among all peoples, from one end of the earth to the other, and there You shall serve other gods of wood and stone, which neither You nor Your fathers have known.
- 65 *And among these nations shalt thou find no ease, neither shall the sole of thy foot have rest: but the LORD shall give thee there a trembling heart, and failing of eyes, and sorrow of mind:* among these nations You shall find no respite, and there shall be no resting place for the sole of Your foot, but the LORD will give You there a trembling heart and failing eyes and a languishing soul.
- 66 *And thy life shall hang in doubt before thee; and thou shalt fear day and night, and shalt have none assurance of thy life:* Your life shall hang in doubt before You. Night and day You shall be in dread and have no assurance of Your life.
- 67 *In the morning thou shalt say, Would God it were even! and at even thou shalt say, Would God it were morning! for the fear of thine heart wherewith thou shalt fear, and for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.* In the morning You shall say, "If only it were evening!" and at evening You shall say, "If only it were morning!" because of the dread that Your heart shall feel, and the sights that Your eyes shall see.

- 68 *And the LORD shall bring thee into Egypt again with ships, by the way whereof I spake unto thee, Thou shalt see it no more again: and there ye shall be sold unto your enemies for bondmen and bondwomen, and no man shall buy you.* the LORD will bring You back in ships to Egypt, a journey that I promised that You should never make again. There You shall offer yourselves for sale to Your enemies as male and female slaves, but there will be no buyer.

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 1:19; Ex 23:22; Lev 26:3-13; Luke 11:28; John 15:14
v2 — Zech 1:6; Deut 28:15; 1 Tim 4:8; Deut 28:45
v3 — Ps 144:12-15; Gen 39:5; Hag 2:19; Gen 26:12; Ps 107:36-37
v4 — Prov 10:22; Gen 49:25; Deut 7:13; Ps 128:3; Deut 28:11
v6 — Ps 121:8; Num 27:17; 2 Chr 1:10; 2 Sam 3:25; Deut 31:2
v7 — 2 Sam 22:38-41; Lev 26:7-8; Ps 89:23; 2 Chr 32:21-22; Josh 8:22
v8 — Deut 15:10; Lev 26:10; Prov 3:9-10; Ps 133:3; Luke 12:18
v9 — Deut 7:6; Ex 19:5-6; Deut 26:18-19; Deut 13:17; Titus 2:14
v11 — Deut 30:9; Prov 10:22; Lev 26:9; Deut 28:4; Ps 132:11
v12 — Deut 15:6; Joel 2:23-24; Deut 11:14; Deut 15:10; Lev 26:4
v64 — Lev 26:33; Deut 4:27-28; Neh 1:8; Jer 16:13; Deut 28:36
v68 — Jer 44:12; Jer 43:7; Hos 8:13; Hos 9:3; Deut 17:16

Chapter 29

Moses makes a covenant with Israel in Moab, in addition to the one at Horeb, rehearsing the LORD's mighty acts in Egypt and the wilderness. He warns that the LORD's anger will burn against anyone who secretly turns to idolatry, and declares that the secret things belong to the LORD but the revealed things belong to Israel and their children forever.

- 1 *These are the words of the covenant, which the LORD commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the land of Moab, beside the covenant which he made with them in Horeb.* These are the words of the covenant that the LORD commanded Moses to make with the people of Israel in the land of Moab, besides the covenant that He had made with them at Horeb.

- 2 *And Moses called unto all Israel, and said unto them, Ye have seen all that the LORD did before your eyes in the land of Egypt unto Pharaoh, and unto all his servants, and unto all his land;* Moses summoned all Israel and said to them: "You have seen all that the LORD did before your eyes in the land of Egypt, to Pharaoh and to all his servants and to all his land,
- 3 *The great temptations which thine eyes have seen, the signs, and those great miracles:* the great trials that Your eyes saw, the signs, and those great wonders.
- 4 *Yet the LORD hath not given you an heart to perceive, and eyes to see, and ears to hear, unto this day.* But to this day the LORD has not given You a heart to understand or eyes to see or ears to hear.
- 5 *And I have led you forty years in the wilderness: your clothes are not waxen old upon you, and thy shoe is not waxen old upon thy foot.* I have led You forty years in the wilderness. Your clothes have not worn out on You, and Your sandals have not worn off Your feet.
- 6 *Ye have not eaten bread, neither have ye drunk wine or strong drink: that ye might know that I am the LORD your God.* You have not eaten bread, and You have not drunk wine or strong drink, that You may know that I am the LORD Your God.
- 7 *And when ye came unto this place, Sihon the king of Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan, came out against us unto battle, and we smote them:* when you came to this place, Sihon the king of Heshbon and Og the king of Bashan came out against us to battle. But we defeated them.
- 8 *And we took their land, and gave it for an inheritance unto the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to the half tribe of Manasseh.* We took their land and gave it for an inheritance to the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 9 *Keep therefore the words of this covenant, and do them, that ye may prosper in all that ye do.* Therefore keep the words of this covenant and do them, that you may prosper in all that you do.
- 10 *Ye stand this day all of you before the LORD your God; your captains of your tribes, your elders, and your officers, with all the men of Israel,* You are standing today, all of You, before the LORD Your God: the heads of Your tribes, Your elders, and Your officers, all the men of Israel,

- 11 *Your little ones, your wives, and thy stranger that is in thy camp, from the hewer of thy wood unto the drawer of thy water:* your little ones, Your wives, and the sojourner who is in Your camp, from the one who chops your wood to the one who draws your water,
- 12 *That thou shouldest enter into covenant with the LORD thy God, and into his oath, which the LORD thy God maketh with thee this day:* so that You may enter into the sworn covenant of the LORD Your God, which the LORD Your God is making with You today,
- 13 *That he may establish thee to day for a people unto himself, and that he may be unto thee a God, as he hath said unto thee, and as he hath sworn unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.* that he may establish you today as his people, and that he may be your God, as He promised you, and as He swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.
- 14 *Neither with you only do I make this covenant and this oath;* It is not with you alone that I am making this sworn covenant,
- 15 *But with him that standeth here with us this day before the LORD our God, and also with him that is not here with us this day:* but with whoever is standing here with us today before the LORD our God, and with whoever is not here with us today.
- 16 *(For ye know how we have dwelt in the land of Egypt; and how we came through the nations which ye passed by;* For You know how we lived in the land of Egypt, and how we came through the midst of the nations through which you passed.
- 17 *And ye have seen their abominations, and their idols, wood and stone, silver and gold, which were among them:)* you have seen their detestable things, their idols of wood and stone, of silver and gold, which were among them.)
- 18 *Lest there should be among you man, or woman, or family, or tribe, whose heart turneth away this day from the LORD our God, to go and serve the gods of these nations; lest there should be among you a root that beareth gall and wormwood;* Beware lest there be among You a man or woman or clan or tribe whose heart is turning away today from the LORD our God to go and serve the gods of those nations. Beware lest there be among You a root bearing poisonous and bitter fruit,

- 19 *And it come to pass, when he heareth the words of this curse, that he bless himself in his heart, saying, I shall have peace, though I walk in the imagination of mine heart, to add drunkenness to thirst:* one who, when He hears the words of this sworn covenant, blesses Himself in His heart, saying, "I shall be safe, though I walk in the stubbornness of my heart." This will lead to adding drunkenness to thirst.
- 20 *The LORD will not spare him, but then the anger of the LORD and his jealousy shall smoke against that man, and all the curses that are written in this book shall lie upon him, and the LORD shall blot out his name from under heaven.* The LORD will not be willing to forgive Him, but rather the anger of the LORD and His jealousy will smoke against that man, and the curses written in this book will settle on Him. The LORD will blot out His name from under heaven.
- 21 *And the LORD shall separate him unto evil out of all the tribes of Israel, according to all the curses of the covenant that are written in this book of the law:* the LORD will single Him out from all the tribes of Israel for calamity, in accordance with all the curses of the covenant written in this Book of the Law.
- 22 *So that the generation to come of your children that shall rise up after you, and the stranger that shall come from a far land, shall say, when they see the plagues of that land, and the sicknesses which the LORD hath laid upon it;* the next generation, Your children who rise up after You, and the foreigner who comes from a far land, will say, when they see the afflictions of that land and the sicknesses with which the LORD has made it sick—
- 23 *And that the whole land thereof is brimstone, and salt, and burning, that it is not sown, nor beareth, nor any grass groweth therein, like the overthrow of Sodom, and Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboim, which the LORD overthrew in his anger, and in his wrath:* the whole land burned out with brimstone and salt, nothing sown and nothing growing, where no plant grows, like the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in His anger and wrath—

- 24 *Even all nations shall say, Wherefore hath the LORD done thus unto this land? what meaneth the heat of this great anger?* all the nations will say, "Why has the LORD done thus to this land? What caused the heat of this great anger?"
- 25 *Then men shall say, Because they have forsaken the covenant of the LORD God of their fathers, which he made with them when he brought them forth out of the land of Egypt:* Then people will say, "It is because they abandoned the covenant of the LORD, the God of their fathers, which He made with them when He brought them out of the land of Egypt,
- 26 *For they went and served other gods, and worshipped them, gods whom they knew not, and whom he had not given unto them:* went and served other gods and worshiped them, gods whom they had not known and whom He had not allotted to them.
- 27 *And the anger of the LORD was kindled against this land, to bring upon it all the curses that are written in this book:* Therefore the anger of the LORD was kindled against this land, bringing upon it all the curses written in this book,
- 28 *And the LORD rooted them out of their land in anger, and in wrath, and in great indignation, and cast them into another land, as it is this day.* the LORD uprooted them from their land in anger and fury and great wrath, and cast them into another land, as they are today."
- 29 *The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.* The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things that are revealed belong to us and to our children forever, that we may do all the words of this law.

Words in this chapter:

Gomorraah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Deut 5:2-3
v4 — Eph 4:18; Isa 6:9-10; Prov 20:12; John 8:43; Isa 63:17
v5 — Deut 8:4; Neh 9:21; Deut 8:2; Matt 6:31-32; Deut 1:3
v9 — 1 Kgs 2:3; Deut 4:6; Luke 11:28; Josh 1:7; Deut 29:1
v13 — Ex 6:7; Gen 17:7
v15 — Acts 2:39; 1 Cor 7:14
v18 — Heb 12:15; Deut 11:16-17; Jer 9:15; Deut 13:1-15
v19 — Jer 7:24; Num 15:30; Num 15:39
v20 — Ps 74:1; Deut 9:14; Ps 79:5
v23 — Jer 17:6; Zeph 2:9
v28 — 2 Chr 7:20; 1 Kgs 14:15
v29 — Dan 2:22; Acts 1:7; Rom 11:33-34; Matt 13:11; Job 11:6-7

Chapter 30

Moses promises that when Israel returns to the LORD after exile, He will gather them from all the nations and circumcise their hearts to love Him. He sets before them life and death, blessing and cursing, and calls heaven and earth as witnesses, urging them to choose life.

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| <p>1 <i>And it shall come to pass, when all these things are come upon thee, the blessing and the curse, which I have set before thee, and thou shalt call them to mind among all the nations, whither the LORD thy God hath driven thee,</i></p> | <p>when all these things come upon You, the blessing and the curse, which I have set before You, and You call them to mind among all the nations where the LORD Your God has driven You,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And shalt return unto the LORD thy God, and shalt obey his voice according to all that I command thee this day, thou and thy children, with all thine heart, and with all thy soul;</i></p> | <p>return to the LORD Your God, You and Your children, and obey His voice in all that I command You today, with all Your heart and with all Your soul,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>That then the LORD thy God will turn thy captivity, and have compassion upon thee, and will return and gather thee from all the nations, whither the LORD thy God hath scattered thee.</i></p> | <p>then the LORD Your God will restore Your fortunes and have mercy on You. He will gather You again from all the peoples where the LORD Your God has scattered You.</p> |

- 4 *If any of thine be driven out unto the outmost parts of heaven, from thence will the LORD thy God gather thee, and from thence will he fetch thee:* If Your outcasts are in the uttermost parts of heaven, from there the LORD Your God will gather You, and from there He will take You.
- 5 *And the LORD thy God will bring thee into the land which thy fathers possessed, and thou shalt possess it; and he will do thee good, and multiply thee above thy fathers.* the LORD Your God will bring You into the land that Your fathers possessed, that You may possess it. And He will make You more prosperous and numerous than Your fathers.
- 6 *And the LORD thy God will circumcise thine heart, and the heart of thy seed, to love the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul, that thou mayest live.* the LORD Your God will circumcise Your heart and the heart of Your seed, so that You will love the LORD Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul, that You may live.
- 7 *And the LORD thy God will put all these curses upon thine enemies, and on them that hate thee, which persecuted thee.* the LORD Your God will put all these curses on Your foes and enemies who persecuted You.
- 8 *And thou shalt return and obey the voice of the LORD, and do all his commandments which I command thee this day.* you shall again obey the voice of the LORD and keep all His commandments that I command You today.
- 9 *And the LORD thy God will make thee plenteous in every work of thine hand, in the fruit of thy body, and in the fruit of thy cattle, and in the fruit of thy land, for good: for the LORD will again rejoice over thee for good, as he rejoiced over thy fathers:* The LORD Your God will make You abundantly prosperous in all the work of Your hand, in the fruit of Your womb and in the fruit of Your cattle and in the fruit of Your ground. For the LORD will again take delight in prospering You, as He took delight in Your fathers,

- 10 *If thou shalt hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep his commandments and his statutes which are written in this book of the law, and if thou turn unto the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul.* when You obey the voice of the LORD Your God, to keep His commandments and His statutes that are written in this Book of the Law, when You turn to the LORD Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul.
- 11 *For this commandment which I command thee this day, it is not hidden from thee, neither is it far off.* For this commandment that I command You today is not too hard for You, neither is it far off.
- 12 *It is not in heaven, that thou shouldest say, Who shall go up for us to heaven, and bring it unto us, that we may hear it, and do it?* It is not in heaven, that You should say, "Who will ascend to heaven for us and bring it to us, that we may hear it and do it?"
- 13 *Neither is it beyond the sea, that thou shouldest say, Who shall go over the sea for us, and bring it unto us, that we may hear it, and do it?* Neither is it beyond the sea, that You should say, "Who will go over the sea for us and bring it to us, that we may hear it and do it?"
- 14 *But the word is very nigh unto thee, in thy mouth, and in thy heart, that thou mayest do it.* But the word is very near You. It is in Your mouth and in Your heart, so that You can do it.
- 15 *See, I have set before thee this day life and good, and death and evil;* See, I have set before You today life and good, death and evil.
- 16 *In that I command thee this day to love the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, and to keep his commandments and his statutes and his judgments, that thou mayest live and multiply: and the LORD thy God shall bless thee in the land whither thou goest to possess it.* If You obey the commandments of the LORD Your God that I command You today, by loving the LORD Your God, by walking in His ways, and by keeping His commandments and His statutes and His rules, then You shall live and multiply. The LORD Your God will bless You in the land that You are entering to take possession of it.

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| <p>17 <i>But if thine heart turn away, so that thou wilt not hear, but shalt be drawn away, and worship other gods, and serve them;</i></p> <p>18 <i>I denounce unto you this day, that ye shall surely perish, and that ye shall not prolong your days upon the land, whither thou passest over Jordan to go to possess it.</i></p> <p>19 <i>I call heaven and earth to record this day against you, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing: therefore choose life, that both thou and thy seed may live:</i></p> <p>20 <i>That thou mayest love the LORD thy God, and that thou mayest obey his voice, and that thou mayest cleave unto him: for he is thy life, and the length of thy days: that thou mayest dwell in the land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.</i></p> | <p>But if Your heart turns away, and You will not hear, but are drawn away to worship other gods and serve them,</p> <p>I declare to You today, that You shall surely perish. You shall not live long in the land that You are going over the Jordan to enter and possess.</p> <p>I call heaven and earth to witness against You today, that I have set before You life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life, that You and Your seed may live,</p> <p>loving the LORD Your God, obeying His voice and holding fast to Him, for He is Your life and length of days, that You may dwell in the land that the LORD swore to Your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 30:15; 1 Kgs 8:47-48; Deut 30:19; Deut 29:28; Deut 11:26-28
- v2 — Joel 2:12-13; Deut 4:28-31; Neh 1:9
- v3 — Jer 29:14; Ezek 36:24; Ps 147:2; Ezek 34:12-13; Lam 3:32
- v4 — Neh 1:9; Ezek 39:25-29; Deut 28:64; Isa 11:11-16; Isa 43:6
- v6 — Ezek 36:26-27; Deut 10:16; Jer 32:39; Ezek 11:19-20; Rom 2:28-29
- v9 — Deut 28:11-14; Jer 32:41; Jer 33:9; Deut 28:4
- v11 — Ps 147:19-20; Isa 45:19; Rom 16:25-26
- v14 — Rom 10:8-10; Jer 12:2; John 5:46; Matt 7:21
- v15 — Deut 11:26; Deut 30:19; Gal 3:13-14; 1 John 5:11-12; Deut 28:1-14

v16 — Deut 30:6; Matt 22:37-38; 1 John 5:2-3; Deut 6:5; John 14:21

v19 — Deut 30:15; Deut 11:26; Ps 119:30; Josh 24:15-22; Prov 8:36

v20 — Deut 10:20; John 11:25-26; John 17:3; Acts 17:25; John 14:6

Chapter 31

Moses, now 120 years old, tells Israel he can no longer go out and come in, and commissions Joshua before all the people. He writes the law and commands the Levites to read it to all Israel every seven years at the Feast of Tabernacles. The LORD tells Moses that Israel will break the covenant after his death.

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| 1 <i>And Moses went and spake these words unto all Israel.</i> | So Moses continued speaking these words to all Israel. |
| 2 <i>And he said unto them, I am an hundred and twenty years old this day; I can no more go out and come in: also the LORD hath said unto me, Thou shalt not go over this Jordan.</i> | he said to them, "I am 120 years old today. I am no longer able to go out and come in. The LORD has said to me, 'You shall not go over this Jordan.' |
| 3 <i>The LORD thy God, he will go over before thee, and he will destroy these nations from before thee, and thou shalt possess them: and Joshua, he shall go over before thee, as the LORD hath said.</i> | The LORD Your God Himself will go over before You. He will destroy these nations before You, so that You shall dispossess them, and Joshua will go over before you, as the LORD has spoken. |
| 4 <i>And the LORD shall do unto them as he did to Sihon and to Og, kings of the Amorites, and unto the land of them, whom he destroyed.</i> | the LORD will do to them as He did to Sihon and Og, the kings of the Amorites, and to their land, when He destroyed them. |
| 5 <i>And the LORD shall give them up before your face, that ye may do unto them according unto all the commandments which I have commanded you.</i> | the LORD will give them over to You, and You shall do to them according to the whole commandment that I have commanded You. |
| 6 <i>Be strong and of a good courage, fear not, nor be afraid of them: for the LORD thy God, he it is that doth go with thee; he will not fail thee, nor forsake thee.</i> | Be strong and courageous. Do not fear or be in dread of them, for it is the LORD Your God Who goes with You. He will not leave You or forsake You." |

- 7 *And Moses called unto Joshua, and said unto him in the sight of all Israel, Be strong and of a good courage: for thou must go with this people unto the land which the LORD hath sworn unto their fathers to give them; and thou shalt cause them to inherit it.* Then Moses summoned Joshua and said to him in the sight of all Israel, "Be strong and courageous, for You shall go with this people into the land that the LORD has sworn to their fathers to give them, and You shall put them in possession of it.
- 8 *And the LORD, he it is that doth go before thee; he will be with thee, he will not fail thee, neither forsake thee: fear not, neither be dismayed.* It is the LORD Who goes before You. He will be with You; He will not leave You or forsake You. Do not fear or be dismayed."
- 9 *And Moses wrote this law, and delivered it unto the priests the sons of Levi, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and unto all the elders of Israel.* Then Moses wrote this law and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and to all the elders of Israel.
- 10 *And Moses commanded them, saying, At the end of every seven years, in the solemnity of the year of release, in the feast of tabernacles,* Moses commanded them, "At the end of every seven years, at the set time in the year of release, at the feast of tabernacles,
- 11 *When all Israel is come to appear before the LORD thy God in the place which he shall choose, thou shalt read this law before all Israel in their hearing.* when all Israel comes to appear before the LORD Your God at the place that He will choose, You shall read this law before all Israel in their hearing.
- 12 *Gather the people together, men, and women, and children, and thy stranger that is within thy gates, that they may hear, and that they may learn, and fear the LORD your God, and observe to do all the words of this law:* Assemble the people, men, women, and little ones, and the sojourner within Your towns, that they may hear and learn to fear the LORD Your God, and be careful to do all the words of this law,

- 13 *And that their children, which have not known any thing, may hear, and learn to fear the LORD your God, as long as ye live in the land whither ye go over Jordan to possess it.* that their children, who have not known it, may hear and learn to fear the LORD Your God, as long as You live in the land that You are going over the Jordan to possess."
- 14 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Behold, thy days approach that thou must die: call Joshua, and present yourselves in the tabernacle of the congregation, that I may give him a charge. And Moses and Joshua went, and presented themselves in the tabernacle of the congregation.* The LORD said to Moses, 'The days approach when you must die. Call Joshua and present yourselves in the tent of meeting, that I may give him a charge.' And Moses and Joshua went and presented themselves in the tent of meeting.
- 15 *And the LORD appeared in the tabernacle in a pillar of a cloud: and the pillar of the cloud stood over the door of the tabernacle.* the LORD appeared in the tent in a pillar of cloud. And the pillar of cloud stood over the entrance of the tent.
- 16 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Behold, thou shalt sleep with thy fathers; and this people will rise up, and go a whoring after the gods of the strangers of the land, whither they go to be among them, and will forsake me, and break my covenant which I have made with them.* The LORD said to Moses, 'You are about to lie down with your fathers. Then this people will rise and whore after the foreign gods among them in the land that they are entering. They will forsake me and break my covenant that I have made with them.
- 17 *Then my anger shall be kindled against them in that day, and I will forsake them, and I will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured, and many evils and troubles shall befall them; so that they will say in that day, Are not these evils come upon us, because our God is not among us?* Then my anger will be kindled against them in that day. I will forsake them and hide my face from them. They will be devoured. And many evils and troubles will come upon them, so that they will say in that day, 'Have not these evils come upon us because our God is not among us?'

- 18 *And I will surely hide my face in that day for all the evils which they shall have wrought, in that they are turned unto other gods.* I will surely hide my face in that day because of all the evil that they have done, because they have turned to other gods.
- 19 *Now therefore write ye this song for you, and teach it the children of Israel: put it in their mouths, that this song may be a witness for me against the children of Israel.* Now therefore write this song and teach it to the people of Israel. Put it in their mouths, that this song may be a witness for me against the people of Israel.
- 20 *For when I shall have brought them into the land which I swear unto their fathers, that floweth with milk and honey; and they shall have eaten and filled themselves, and waxen fat; then will they turn unto other gods, and serve them, and provoke me, and break my covenant.* For when I have brought them into the land flowing with milk and honey, which I swore to give to their fathers. They have eaten and are full and grown fat, they will turn to other gods and serve them, and despise me and break my covenant.
- 21 *And it shall come to pass, when many evils and troubles are befallen them, that this song shall testify against them as a witness; for it shall not be forgotten out of the mouths of their seed: for I know their imagination which they go about, even now, before I have brought them into the land which I swear.* when many evils and troubles have come upon them, this song shall confront them as a witness (for it will live unforgotten in the mouths of their seed). For I know what they are inclined to do even today, before I have brought them into the land that I swore to give.
- 22 *Moses therefore wrote this song the same day, and taught it the children of Israel.* Moses therefore wrote this song the same day and taught it to the people of Israel.
- 23 *And he gave Joshua the son of Nun a charge, and said, Be strong and of a good courage: for thou shalt bring the children of Israel into the land which I swear unto them: and I will be with thee.* And he gave Joshua the son of Nun a charge, and said, "Be strong and courageous, for you shall bring the people of Israel into the land that I swore to give them. I will be with you."

- 24 *And it came to pass, when Moses had made an end of writing the words of this law in a book, until they were finished,* When Moses had finished writing the words of this law in a book to the very end,
- 25 *That Moses commanded the Levites, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, saying,* Moses commanded the Levites who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD,
- 26 *Take this book of the law, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, that it may be there for a witness against thee.* "Take this Book of the Law and put it by the side of the ark of the covenant of the LORD Your God, that it may be there for a witness against You.
- 27 *For I know thy rebellion, and thy stiff neck: behold, while I am yet alive with you this day, ye have been rebellious against the LORD; and how much more after my death?* For I know how rebellious and stubborn You are. Even today while I am yet alive with You, You have been rebellious against the LORD. How much more after my death!
- 28 *Gather unto me all the elders of your tribes, and your officers, that I may speak these words in their ears, and call heaven and earth to record against them.* Assemble to me all the elders of Your tribes and Your officers, that I may speak these words in their ears and call heaven and earth to witness against them.
- 29 *For I know that after my death ye will utterly corrupt yourselves, and turn aside from the way which I have commanded you; and evil will befall you in the latter days; because ye will do evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger through the work of your hands.* For I know that after my death You will surely act corruptly and turn aside from the way that I have commanded You. And in the days to come, evil will befall You, because You will do what is evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger through the work of Your hands."
- 30 *And Moses spake in the ears of all the congregation of Israel the words of this song, until they were ended.* Then Moses spoke the words of this song until they were finished, in the ears of all the assembly of Israel:

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 34:7; Num 27:17; 1 Kgs 3:7
- v3 — Deut 9:3; Deut 31:23; Deut 3:28
- v6 — Josh 1:9; Eph 6:10; Ps 27:14; 1 Chr 28:20; Isa 41:10
- v7 — Deut 3:28; Deut 31:6; Deut 1:38; Eph 6:10
- v8 — Ex 33:14; Deut 31:6; Josh 1:9; Rom 8:31; Josh 1:5
- v10 — Deut 15:1-2; Lev 23:34-43
- v11 — 2 Kgs 23:2; Josh 8:34-35; Deut 16:16-17
- v16 — Judg 10:6; Judg 2:12; Judg 10:13; Ex 34:15; Rev 19:2
- v17 — 2 Chr 15:2; Judg 6:13; Isa 8:17; Num 14:42; Ps 104:29
- v19 — Deut 6:7; Deut 31:21-22
- v20 — Hos 13:6; Neh 9:25-26; Deut 6:10-12; Ex 3:8
- v28 — Deut 4:26; Deut 32:1; Deut 30:19

Chapter 32

Moses recites the Song of Moses before all Israel, declaring God's faithfulness and Israel's future unfaithfulness. The song recounts how the LORD found Israel in the wilderness and carried them, how they grew fat and forsook Him, and how He will vindicate His people in the end. Afterward the LORD tells Moses to go up Mount Nebo to die.

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| 1 | <i>Give ear, O ye heavens, and I will speak; and hear, O earth, the words of my mouth.</i> | Give ear, O heavens. I will speak, and let the earth hear the words of my mouth. |
| 2 | <i>My doctrine shall drop as the rain, my speech shall distil as the dew, as the small rain upon the tender herb, and as the showers upon the grass:</i> | May my teaching drop as the rain, my speech distill as the dew, like gentle rain upon the tender grass, and like showers upon the herb. |
| 3 | <i>Because I will publish the name of the LORD: ascribe ye greatness unto our God.</i> | For I will proclaim the name of the LORD; ascribe greatness to our God! |
| 4 | <i>He is the Rock, his work is perfect: for all his ways are judgment: a God of truth and without iniquity, just and right is he.</i> | The Rock, His work is perfect, for all His ways are justice. A God of faithfulness and without iniquity, just and upright is He. |

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| 5 <i>They have corrupted themselves, their spot is not the spot of his children: they are a perverse and crooked generation.</i> | They have dealt corruptly with Him; their spot is not the spot of His children; they are a crooked and twisted generation. |
| 6 <i>Do ye thus requite the LORD, O foolish people and unwise? is not he thy father that hath bought thee? hath he not made thee, and established thee?</i> | Do You thus repay the LORD, You foolish and senseless people? Is not He Your father, who created You, who made You and established You? |
| 7 <i>Remember the days of old, consider the years of many generations: ask thy father, and he will shew thee; thy elders, and they will tell thee.</i> | Remember the days of old; consider the years of many generations; ask Your father. He will show You, Your elders. They will tell You. |
| 8 <i>When the Most High divided to the nations their inheritance, when he separated the sons of Adam, he set the bounds of the people according to the number of the children of Israel.</i> | When the Most High gave to the nations their inheritance, when he separated the sons of Adam, he fixed the borders of the peoples according to the number of the children of Israel. |
| 9 <i>For the LORD's portion is his people; Jacob is the lot of his inheritance.</i> | But the LORD's portion is His people, Jacob his allotted heritage. |
| 10 <i>He found him in a desert land, and in the waste howling wilderness; he led him about, he instructed him, he kept him as the apple of his eye.</i> | He found Him in a desert land, and in the howling waste of the wilderness; He encircled Him, He cared for Him, He kept Him as the apple of His eye. |
| 11 <i>As an eagle stirreth up her nest, fluttereth over her young, spreadeth abroad her wings, taketh them, beareth them on her wings:</i> | Like an eagle that stirs up its nest, that flutters over its young, spreading out its wings, catching them, bearing them on its pinions, |
| 12 <i>So the LORD alone did lead him, and there was no strange god with him.</i> | the LORD alone guided Him, no foreign god was with Him. |

- 13 *He made him ride on the high places of the earth, that he might eat the increase of the fields; and he made him to suck honey out of the rock, and oil out of the flinty rock;* He made Him ride on the high places of the land. He ate the produce of the field. He suckled Him with honey out of the rock, and oil out of the flinty rock.
- 14 *Butter of kine, and milk of sheep, with fat of lambs, and rams of the breed of Bashan, and goats, with the fat of kidneys of wheat; and thou didst drink the pure blood of the grape.* Curds from the herd, and milk from the flock, with fat of lambs, rams of Bashan and goats, with the finest of the wheat—and You drank foaming wine made from the blood of the grape.
- 15 *But Jeshurun waxed fat, and kicked: thou art waxen fat, thou art grown thick, thou art covered with fatness; then he forsook God which made him, and lightly esteemed the Rock of his salvation.* But Jeshurun grew fat and kicked; You grew fat, stout, and sleek; then He forsook God Who made Him and scoffed at the Rock of His salvation.
- 16 *They provoked him to jealousy with strange gods, with abominations provoked they him to anger.* They stirred Him to jealousy with strange gods; with abominations they provoked Him to anger.
- 17 *They sacrificed unto devils, not to God; to gods whom they knew not, to new gods that came newly up, whom your fathers feared not.* They sacrificed to demons that were no gods, to gods they had never known, to new gods that had come recently, whom Your fathers had never dreaded.
- 18 *Of the Rock that begat thee thou art unmindful, and hast forgotten God that formed thee.* You were unmindful of the Rock that bore You, and You forgot the God Who gave You birth.
- 19 *And when the LORD saw it, he abhorred them, because of the provoking of his sons, and of his daughters.* The LORD saw it and spurned them, because of the provocation of His sons and His daughters.
- 20 *And he said, I will hide my face from them, I will see what their end shall be: for they are a very froward generation, children in whom is no faith.* he said, "I will hide my face from them; I will see what their end will be, for they are a perverse generation, children in whom is no faithfulness.

- 21 *They have moved me to jealousy with that which is not God; they have provoked me to anger with their vanities: and I will move them to jealousy with those which are not a people; I will provoke them to anger with a foolish nation.* They have made me jealous with what is no god; they have provoked me to anger with their idols. So I will make them jealous with those who are no people; I will provoke them to anger with a foolish nation.
- 22 *For a fire is kindled in mine anger, and shall burn unto the lowest hell, and shall consume the earth with her increase, and set on fire the foundations of the mountains.* For a fire is kindled by my anger. It burns to the depths of hell, devours the earth and its increase, and sets on fire the foundations of the mountains.
- 23 *I will heap mischiefs upon them; I will spend mine arrows upon them.* I will heap disasters upon them; I will spend my arrows against them;
- 24 *They shall be burnt with hunger, and devoured with burning heat, and with bitter destruction: I will also send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the poison of serpents of the dust.* they shall be wasted with hunger, and devoured by plague and poisonous pestilence; I will send the teeth of beasts against them, with the venom of things that crawl in the dust.
- 25 *The sword without, and terror within, shall destroy both the young man and the virgin, the suckling also with the man of gray hairs.* Outdoors the sword shall bereave, and indoors terror, for the young man and the young woman, the nursing child with the man of gray hairs.
- 26 *I said, I would scatter them into corners, I would make the remembrance of them to cease from among men:* I would have said, "I will cut them to pieces; I will wipe them from human memory,"
- 27 *Were it not that I feared the wrath of the enemy, lest their adversaries should behave themselves strangely, and lest they should say, Our hand is high, and the LORD hath not done all this.* had I not feared provocation by the enemy, lest their adversaries should misunderstand, lest they should say, "Our hand is triumphant, it was not the LORD Who did all this."

- 28 *For they are a nation void of counsel, neither is there any understanding in them.* For they are a nation void of counsel, and there is no understanding in them.
- 29 *O that they were wise, that they understood this, that they would consider their latter end!* If they were wise, they would understand this; they would discern their latter end!
- 30 *How should one chase a thousand, and two put ten thousand to flight, except their Rock had sold them, and the LORD had shut them up?* How could one have chased a thousand, and two have put ten thousand to flight, unless their Rock had sold them, and the LORD had shut them up?
- 31 *For their rock is not as our Rock, even our enemies themselves being judges.* For their rock is not as our Rock; our enemies themselves being judges.
- 32 *For their vine is of the vine of Sodom, and of the fields of Gomorrah: their grapes are grapes of gall, their clusters are bitter:* For their vine comes from the vine of Sodom and from the fields of Gomorrah; their grapes are grapes of poison; their clusters are bitter;
- 33 *Their wine is the poison of dragons, and the cruel venom of asps.* their wine is the poison of serpents and the cruel venom of asps.
- 34 *Is not this laid up in store with me, and sealed up among my treasures?* Is not this laid up in store with me, sealed up in my treasures?
- 35 *To me belongeth vengeance, and recompence; their foot shall slide in due time: for the day of their calamity is at hand, and the things that shall come upon them make haste.* Vengeance is mine, and recompense, for the time when their foot shall slip; for the day of their calamity is at hand. Their doom comes swiftly.
- 36 *For the LORD shall judge his people, and repent himself for his servants, when he seeth that their power is gone, and there is none shut up, or left.* For the LORD will vindicate His people and have compassion on His servants, when he sees that their power is gone and there is none remaining, bond or free.
- 37 *And he shall say, Where are their gods, their rock in whom they trusted,* Then He will say, "Where are their gods, the rock in which they took refuge,

- 38 *Which did eat the fat of their sacrifices, and drank the wine of their drink offerings? let them rise up and help you, and be your protection.* who ate the fat of their sacrifices and drank the wine of their drink offering? Let them rise up and help You; let them be Your protection!
- 39 *See now that I, even I, am he, and there is no god with me: I kill, and I make alive; I wound, and I heal: neither is there any that can deliver out of my hand.* See now that I, even I, am He, and there is no god beside me; I kill and I make alive; I wound and I heal. There is none that can deliver out of my hand.
- 40 *For I lift up my hand to heaven, and say, I live for ever.* For I lift up my hand to heaven and swear, As I live forever,
- 41 *If I whet my glittering sword, and mine hand take hold on judgment; I will render vengeance to mine enemies, and will reward them that hate me.* if I sharpen my flashing sword and my hand takes hold on judgment, I will take vengeance on my adversaries and will repay those who hate me.
- 42 *I will make mine arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh; and that with the blood of the slain and of the captives, from the beginning of revenges upon the enemy.* I will make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh—with the blood of the slain and the captives, from the beginning of revenges upon the enemy."
- 43 *Rejoice, O ye nations, with his people: for he will avenge the blood of his servants, and will render vengeance to his adversaries, and will be merciful unto his land, and to his people.* Rejoice, O nations, with His people, for He will avenge the blood of His servants and render vengeance to his adversaries, and will be merciful to His land and to His people.
- 44 *And Moses came and spake all the words of this song in the ears of the people, he, and Hoshea the son of Nun.* Moses came and recited all the words of this song in the hearing of the people, he and Joshua the son of Nun.
- 45 *And Moses made an end of speaking all these words to all Israel:* when Moses had finished speaking all these words to all Israel,

- 46 *And he said unto them, Set your hearts unto all the words which I testify among you this day, which ye shall command your children to observe to do, all the words of this law.* he said to them, "Take to heart all the words by which I am warning you today, that you may command them to your children, that they may be careful to do all the words of this law.
- 47 *For it is not a vain thing for you; because it is your life: and through this thing ye shall prolong your days in the land, whither ye go over Jordan to possess it.* For it is no empty word for you, but your very life, and by this word you shall live long in the land that you are going over the Jordan to possess."
- 48 *And the LORD spake unto Moses that selfsame day, saying,* the LORD spoke to Moses that same day, saying,
- 49 *Get thee up into this mountain Abarim, unto mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab, that is over against Jericho; and behold the land of Canaan, which I give unto the children of Israel for a possession:* "Go up this mountain of the Abarim, Mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab, opposite Jericho, and view the land of Canaan, which I am giving to the people of Israel for a possession.
- 50 *And die in the mount whither thou goest up, and be gathered unto thy people; as Aaron thy brother died in mount Hor, and was gathered unto his people:* die on the mountain that you go up, and be gathered to your people, as Aaron your brother died on Mount Hor and was gathered to his people,
- 51 *Because ye trespassed against me among the children of Israel at the waters of Meribah-Kadesh, in the wilderness of Zin; because ye sanctified me not in the midst of the children of Israel.* because you broke faith with me in the midst of the people of Israel at the waters of Meribah-kadesh, in the wilderness of Zin, and because you did not treat me as holy in the midst of the people of Israel.
- 52 *Yet thou shalt see the land before thee; but thou shalt not go thither unto the land which I give the children of Israel.* For you shall see the land before you, but you shall not go there, into the land that I am giving to the people of Israel."

Words in this chapter:

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 1:2; Deut 4:26; Ps 49:1; Jer 22:29; Ps 50:4
- v2 — Isa 55:10-11; Ps 72:6; Mic 5:7; Job 29:22-23; Hos 14:5
- v4 — Ps 18:30-31; Ps 92:15; Isa 26:4; Ps 18:2; Dan 4:37
- v5 — Phil 2:15; Isa 1:4; Matt 17:17; Deut 31:29; Luke 9:41
- v7 — Ps 78:3-4; Ps 44:1; Job 8:8-10; Ps 77:5-6; Isa 46:9
- v10 — Zech 2:8; Hos 13:5; Ps 17:8; Deut 8:15-16; Ps 32:7-10
- v15 — Deut 31:20; Hos 13:6; Deut 33:5; Acts 28:27; 1 Sam 2:29
- v21 — Rom 10:19; Rom 9:25; Rom 11:11-14; 1 Kgs 16:26; 1 Kgs 16:13
- v29 — Ps 81:13; Deut 5:29; Hos 14:9; Luke 19:41-42; Luke 12:20
- v30 — Lev 26:8; Josh 23:10; Isa 30:17
- v35 — Rom 12:19; Nah 1:2; Heb 10:30; Ps 73:17-19; 2 Pet 2:3
- v39 — 1 Sam 2:6; Hos 6:1; Job 5:18; Isa 45:5; Isa 45:22

Chapter 33

Moses blesses the twelve tribes of Israel before his death, tribe by tribe. He praises the LORD who rides on the heavens to Israel's help and declares that the eternal God is their refuge and underneath are the everlasting arms.

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| <p>1 <i>And this is the blessing, wherewith Moses the man of God blessed the children of Israel before his death.</i></p> | <p>This is the blessing with which Moses the man of God blessed the people of Israel before his death.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he said, The LORD came from Sinai, and rose up from Seir unto them; he shined forth from mount Paran, and he came with ten thousands of saints: from his right hand went a fiery law for them.</i></p> | <p>He said, "The LORD came from Sinai and dawned from Seir upon us; He shone forth from Mount Paran; He came from the ten thousands of holy ones, with flaming fire at His right hand.</p> |

- 3 *Yea, he loved the people; all his saints are in thy hand: and they sat down at thy feet; every one shall receive of thy words.* Yes, He loved His people, all His holy ones were in His hand; so they followed in Your steps, receiving direction from You,
- 4 *Moses commanded us a law, even the inheritance of the congregation of Jacob.* when Moses commanded us a law, as a possession for the assembly of Jacob.
- 5 *And he was king in Jeshurun, when the heads of the people and the tribes of Israel were gathered together.* Thus the LORD became king in Jeshurun, when the heads of the people were gathered, all the tribes of Israel together.
- 6 *Let Reuben live, and not die; and let not his men be few.* Let Reuben live, and not die, but let His men be few.
- 7 *And this is the blessing of Judah: and he said, Hear, LORD, the voice of Judah, and bring him unto his people: let his hands be sufficient for him; and be thou an help to him from his enemies.* this He said of Judah: "Hear, O LORD, the voice of Judah, and bring Him in to His people. let His hands be sufficient for Him, and be a help against His adversaries."
- 8 *And of Levi he said, Let thy Thummim and thy Urim be with thy holy one, whom thou didst prove at Massah, and with whom thou didst strive at the waters of Meribah;* of Levi He said, "Give to Levi Your Thummim, and Your Urim to Your godly one, whom You tested at Massah, with whom You quarreled at the waters of Meribah,
- 9 *Who said unto his father and to his mother, I have not seen him; neither did he acknowledge his brethren, nor knew his own children: for they have observed thy word, and kept thy covenant.* who said of His father and mother, 'I regard them not'; He disowned His brothers and ignored His children. For they observed Your word and kept Your covenant.
- 10 *They shall teach Jacob thy judgments, and Israel thy law: they shall put incense before thee, and whole burnt sacrifice upon thine altar.* They shall teach Jacob your rules and Israel your law; they shall put incense before you and whole burnt offerings on your altar.

- 11 *Bless, LORD, his substance, and accept the work of his hands: smite through the loins of them that rise against him, and of them that hate him, that they rise not again.* Bless, O LORD, His substance, and accept the work of His hands; crush the loins of His adversaries, of those who hate Him, that they rise not again."
- 12 *And of Benjamin he said, The beloved of the LORD shall dwell in safety by him; and the LORD shall cover him all the day long, and he shall dwell between his shoulders.* Of Benjamin He said, "The beloved of the LORD dwells in safety. The LORD shall cover Him all the day long, and He shall dwell between His shoulders."
- 13 *And of Joseph he said, Blessed of the LORD be his land, for the precious things of heaven, for the dew, and for the deep that coucheth beneath,* of Joseph he said, "Blessed by the LORD be His land, with the choicest gifts of heaven above, and of the deep that crouches beneath,
- 14 *And for the precious fruits brought forth by the sun, and for the precious things put forth by the moon,* with the choicest fruits of the sun and the rich yield of the months,
- 15 *And for the chief things of the ancient mountains, and for the precious things of the lasting hills,* with the finest produce of the ancient mountains and the abundance of the everlasting hills,
- 16 *And for the precious things of the earth and fulness thereof, and for the good will of him that dwelt in the bush: let the blessing come upon the head of Joseph, and upon the top of the head of him that was separated from his brethren.* with the best gifts of the earth and its fullness and the favor of him who dwells in the burning bush. May these rest on the head of Joseph, on the brow of him who was prince among his brothers.
- 17 *His glory is like the firstling of his bullock, and his horns are like the horns of unicorns: with them he shall push the people together to the ends of the earth: and they are the ten thousands of Ephraim, and they are the thousands of Manasseh.* His glory is like the firstling of his bullock, and his horns are like the horns of unicorns. With them he shall push the peoples together to the ends of the earth. They are the ten thousands of Ephraim, and they are the thousands of Manasseh.

- 18 *And of Zebulun he said, Rejoice, Zebulun, in thy going out; and, Issachar, in thy tents.* of Zebulun he said, "Rejoice, Zebulun, in your going out, and Issachar, in your tents.
- 19 *They shall call the people unto the mountain; there they shall offer sacrifices of righteousness: for they shall suck of the abundance of the seas, and of treasures hid in the sand.* They shall call peoples to their mountain; there they offer right sacrifices; for they draw from the abundance of the seas and the hidden treasures of the sand."
- 20 *And of Gad he said, Blessed be he that enlargeth Gad: he dwelleth as a lion, and teareth the arm with the crown of the head.* of Gad he said, "Blessed be he who enlarges Gad! Gad crouches like a lion; he tears off arm and scalp.
- 21 *And he provided the first part for himself, because there, in a portion of the lawgiver, was he seated; and he came with the heads of the people, he executed the justice of the LORD, and his judgments with Israel.* He chose the best of the land for Himself, for there a commander's portion was reserved. He came with the heads of the people, with Israel he executed the justice of the LORD, and His judgments with Israel."
- 22 *And of Dan he said, Dan is a lion's whelp: he shall leap from Bashan.* of Dan He said, "Dan is a lion's cub that leaps from Bashan."
- 23 *And of Naphtali he said, O Naphtali, satisfied with favour, and full with the blessing of the LORD: possess thou the west and the south.* of Naphtali He said, "O Naphtali, satisfied with favor, and full of the blessing of the LORD, possess the lake and the south."
- 24 *And of Asher he said, Let Asher be blessed with children; let him be acceptable to his brethren, and let him dip his foot in oil.* of Asher He said, "Most blessed of sons be Asher; let Him be the favorite of His brothers, and let Him dip His foot in oil.
- 25 *Thy shoes shall be iron and brass; and as thy days, so shall thy strength be.* Your bars shall be iron and bronze, and as Your days, so shall Your strength be.

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| <p>26 <i>There is none like unto the God of Jeshurun, who rideth upon the heaven in thy help, and in his excellency on the sky.</i></p> <p>27 <i>The eternal God is thy refuge, and underneath are the everlasting arms: and he shall thrust out the enemy from before thee; and shall say, Destroy them.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Israel then shall dwell in safety alone: the fountain of Jacob shall be upon a land of corn and wine; also his heavens shall drop down dew.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Happy art thou, O Israel: who is like unto thee, O people saved by the LORD, the shield of thy help, and who is the sword of thy excellency! and thine enemies shall be found liars unto thee; and thou shalt tread upon their high places.</i></p> | <p>There is none like God, O Jeshurun, who rides through the heavens to Your help, through the skies in His majesty.</p> <p>The eternal God is Your dwelling place, and underneath are the everlasting arms. and He shall thrust out the enemy from before you and shall say, Destroy them.</p> <p>So Israel lived in safety, Jacob lived alone, in a land of grain and wine, whose heavens drop down dew.</p> <p>Happy are You, O Israel! Who is like you, a people saved by the LORD, the shield of your help, and the sword of Your triumph! Your enemies shall come fawning to You, and You shall tread upon their high places."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Thummim (*THUM-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate alongside the Urim — together they were God's tool for giving yes/no answers to Israel's leaders.

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Sinai (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Hab 3:3; Jude 1:14; Rev 5:11; Acts 7:53; Ps 68:17
v3 — Luke 10:39; Mal 1:2; Deut 7:6-8
v6 — Gen 49:8; Num 32:31-32; Josh 22:1-9
v8 — Ex 17:7; Ex 28:30; Num 20:13
v17 — 1 Kgs 22:11; Num 23:22; Ps 44:5
v23 — Gen 49:21; Ps 36:8; Jer 31:14; Matt 4:16; Matt 4:13
v24 — Gen 49:20; Rom 14:18; Job 29:6; Prov 3:3-4; Ps 128:6
v25 — Isa 41:10; Col 1:11; Phil 4:13; Ps 138:3; Isa 40:29
v26 — Ex 15:11; Isa 43:11-13; Jer 10:6; Hab 3:8; Ps 104:3
v27 — Ps 90:1-2; Ps 18:2; Isa 25:4; Ps 91:1-2; Ps 46:1
v28 — Num 23:9; Ex 33:16; Gen 27:28; Jer 23:6; Rev 21:27
v29 — Isa 12:2; Isa 45:17; Deut 4:7-8; Ps 115:9-11; 2 Sam 7:23

Chapter 34

Moses goes up Mount Nebo and the LORD shows him all the Promised Land from Gilead to the western sea. Moses dies there at 120 years old, his eye undimmed and his strength unabated, and the LORD buries him in an unknown grave. Joshua the son of Nun succeeds him, but no prophet like Moses has arisen in Israel since.

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| <p>1 <i>And Moses went up from the plains of Moab unto the mountain of Nebo, to the top of Pisgah, that is over against Jericho. And the LORD shewed him all the land of Gilead, unto Dan,</i></p> <p>2 <i>And all Naphtali, and the land of Ephraim, and Manasseh, and all the land of Judah, unto the utmost sea,</i></p> <p>3 <i>And the south, and the plain of the valley of Jericho, the city of palm trees, unto Zoar.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And the LORD said unto him, This is the land which I sware unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, saying, I will give it unto thy seed: I have caused thee to see it with thine eyes, but thou shalt not go over thither.</i></p> | <p>Then Moses went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo, to the top of Pisgah, which is opposite Jericho. And the LORD showed Him all the land, Gilead as far as Dan,</p> <p>all Naphtali, the land of Ephraim and Manasseh, all the land of Judah as far as the western sea,</p> <p>the south, and the Plain, that is, the Valley of Jericho the city of palm trees, as far as Zoar.</p> <p>the LORD said to him, "This is the land of which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, 'I will give it to your seed.' I have let you see it with your eyes, but you shall not go over there."</p> |
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| <p>5 <i>So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the word of the LORD.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And he buried him in a valley in the land of Moab, over against Bethpeor: but no man knoweth of his sepulchre unto this day.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And Moses was an hundred and twenty years old when he died: his eye was not dim, nor his natural force abated.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And the children of Israel wept for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days: so the days of weeping and mourning for Moses were ended.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Joshua the son of Nun was full of the spirit of wisdom; for Moses had laid his hands upon him: and the children of Israel hearkened unto him, and did as the LORD commanded Moses.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And there arose not a prophet since in Israel like unto Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face,</i></p> <p>11 <i>In all the signs and the wonders, which the LORD sent him to do in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to all his land,</i></p> <p>12 <i>And in all that mighty hand, and in all the great terror which Moses shewed in the sight of all Israel.</i></p> | <p>So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the word of the LORD.</p> <p>he buried Him in the valley in the land of Moab opposite Beth-peor, but no one knows the place of his burial to this day.</p> <p>Moses was 120 years old when he died. His eye was undimmed and his vigor unabated.</p> <p>the people of Israel wept for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days. Then the days of weeping and mourning for Moses were ended.</p> <p>Joshua the son of Nun was full of the spirit of wisdom, for Moses had laid his hands on him. So the people of Israel obeyed him and did as the LORD had commanded Moses.</p> <p>there has not arisen a prophet since in Israel like Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face,</p> <p>none like Him for all the signs and the wonders that the LORD sent Him to do in the land of Egypt, to Pharaoh and to all his servants and to all his land,</p> <p>for all the mighty power and all the great deeds of terror that Moses did in the sight of all Israel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v2 — Deut 11:24

v3 — 2 Chr 28:15; Judg 1:16; Judg 3:13

v4 — Deut 32:52; Gen 12:7

v5 — Deut 32:50; Josh 1:1-2; Heb 3:3-6

v6 — Jude 1:9

v7 — Deut 31:2; Josh 14:10-11; Gen 27:1; Gen 48:10; Acts 7:36

v8 — Num 20:29; Gen 50:3; Gen 50:10

v9 — Isa 11:2; John 3:34; Acts 6:6; Dan 6:3; Acts 8:17-19

v10 — Ex 33:11; Num 12:6-8

v11 — Deut 7:19; Deut 4:34

Joshua

Author: Joshua, traditionally — he is named as the author within the book (Josh 24:26), with later additions noting his death.

Date written: Core material written during or shortly after Joshua's leadership, c. 1400–1375 BC; final editing possibly by Phinehas or Samuel.

Written to: The nation of Israel as it settled into the Promised Land.

Setting: Moses is dead. Forty years of wilderness wandering are over. Israel stands on the east bank of the Jordan, and God commands them to cross and possess the land He promised to Abraham four centuries earlier.

Where this sits historically: c. 1406–1380 BC, the conquest of Canaan during Egypt's late 18th dynasty under Amenhotep III and the Amarna age that followed.

Contemporaries: Egypt's Amenhotep III / Akhenaten and the Amarna letters describing chaos in Canaan; the Hittite empire's rise. Judges follows directly after Joshua's death.

Big themes:

- Fulfillment of promise — every step into Canaan is God keeping the oath He swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob
- Holy war — the conquest is an act of divine judgment on the Canaanite nations; Israel is God's instrument of justice, not merely an invading army
- Faith in action — Rahab's faith (ch. 2), the Jordan crossing (ch. 3), and Jericho's walls (ch. 6) all demonstrate that victory comes through trusting God's word, not military strength
- Land as inheritance — the detailed allotments of chapters 13–21 are not bureaucratic tedium; every tribe receiving land is a fulfillment of the covenant
- Covenant renewal — the book opens and closes with commands to keep the law; Joshua's farewell speech (ch. 24) forces a decision: whom will you serve?

Key passages: Josh 1:8–9; 2:11; 3:17; 6:20; 24:15

How it fits: Joshua is the fulfillment of the Exodus — everything Moses promised about entering the land comes true here. Hebrews 4 uses Israel's rest in Canaan as a type of the believer's rest in Christ. Judges opens immediately after Joshua's death, showing how quickly the nation forgot what God had done.

Chapter 1

God commanded Joshua to lead Israel across the Jordan into the Promised Land, promising to be with him as He was with Moses. The eastern tribes pledged their obedience, and Joshua ordered the people to prepare provisions for crossing within three days.

- 1 *Now after the death of Moses the servant of the LORD it came to pass, that the LORD spake unto Joshua the son of Nun, Moses' minister, saying,* After the death of Moses the servant of the LORD, the LORD said to Joshua the son of Nun, Moses' assistant,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joshua** (JOSH-oo-ah) — "the LORD is salvation" — Son of Nun, of the tribe of Ephraim. Moses' assistant and successor who led Israel across the Jordan into the Promised Land. His name is the Hebrew form of "Jesus" — he is a type of Christ bringing God's people into their inheritance.

- 2 *Moses my servant is dead; now therefore arise, go over this Jordan, thou, and all this people, unto the land which I do give to them, even to the children of Israel.* "Moses my servant is dead. Now therefore arise, go over this Jordan, you and all this people, into the land that I am giving to them, to the people of Israel.
- 3 *Every place that the sole of your foot shall tread upon, that have I given unto you, as I said unto Moses.* Every place that the sole of your foot will tread upon I have given to you, just as I promised to Moses.
- 4 *From the wilderness and this Lebanon even unto the great river, the river Euphrates, all the land of the Hittites, and unto the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your coast.* From the wilderness and this Lebanon as far as the great river, the river Euphrates, all the land of the Hittites to the Great Sea toward the going down of the sun shall be your territory.
- 5 *There shall not any man be able to stand before thee all the days of thy life: as I was with Moses, so I will be with thee: I will not fail thee, nor forsake thee.* No man shall be able to stand before you all the days of your life. Just as I was with Moses, so I will be with you. I will not leave you or forsake you.
- 6 *Be strong and of a good courage: for unto this people shalt thou divide for an inheritance the land, which I swore unto their fathers to give them.* Be strong and courageous, for you shall cause this people to inherit the land that I swore to their fathers to give them.

- 7 *Only be thou strong and very courageous, that thou mayest observe to do according to all the law, which Moses my servant commanded thee: turn not from it to the right hand or to the left, that thou mayest prosper whithersoever thou goest.* Only be strong and very courageous, being careful to do according to all the law that Moses my servant commanded you. Do not turn from it to the right hand or to the left, that you may have good success wherever you go.
- 8 *This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.* This Book of the Law shall not depart from your mouth, but you shall meditate on it day and night, so that you may be careful to do according to all that is written in it. For then you will make your way prosperous, and then you will have good success.
- 9 *Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, neither be thou dismayed: for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.* Have I not commanded You? Be strong and courageous. Do not be frightened, and do not be dismayed, for the LORD Your God is with You wherever You go."
- 10 *Then Joshua commanded the officers of the people, saying,* Joshua commanded the officers of the people,
- 11 *Pass through the host, and command the people, saying, Prepare you victuals; for within three days ye shall pass over this Jordan, to go in to possess the land, which the LORD your God giveth you to possess it.* "Pass through the midst of the camp and command the people, 'Prepare your provisions, for within three days You are to pass over this Jordan to go in to take possession of the land that the LORD Your God is giving You to possess.' "
- 12 *And to the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to half the tribe of Manasseh, spake Joshua, saying,* to the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh Joshua said,

- 13 *Remember the word which Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, saying, The LORD your God hath given you rest, and hath given you this land.* "Remember the word that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded You, saying, 'The LORD Your God is providing You a place of rest and will give You this land.'
- 14 *Your wives, your little ones, and your cattle, shall remain in the land which Moses gave you on this side Jordan; but ye shall pass over before your brethren armed, all the mighty men of valour, and help them;* Your wives, your little ones, and your livestock shall remain in the land that Moses gave you beyond the Jordan. But all the men of valor among you shall cross over armed before your brothers and shall help them,
- 15 *Until the LORD have given your brethren rest, as he hath given you, and they also have possessed the land which the LORD your God giveth them: then ye shall return unto the land of your possession, and enjoy it, which Moses the LORD's servant gave you on this side Jordan toward the sunrising.* until the LORD gives rest to Your brothers as He has to You. They also take possession of the land that the LORD Your God is giving them. Then You shall return to the land of Your possession and shall possess it, the land that Moses the servant of the LORD gave You beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise."
- 16 *And they answered Joshua, saying, All that thou commandest us we will do, and whithersoever thou sendest us, we will go.* they answered Joshua, "All that you have commanded us we will do, and wherever you send us we will go.
- 17 *According as we hearkened unto Moses in all things, so will we hearken unto thee: only the LORD thy God be with thee, as he was with Moses.* Just as we obeyed Moses in all things, so we will obey you. Only may the LORD Your God be with You, as He was with Moses!
- 18 *Whosoever he be that doth rebel against thy commandment, and will not hearken unto thy words in all that thou commandest him, he shall be put to death: only be strong and of a good courage.* Whoever rebels against your commandment and disobeys Your words, whatever You command Him, shall be put to death. Only be strong and courageous."

Words in this chapter:

- victuals** (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'
- Hittites** (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.
- Joshua** (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.
- Euphrates** (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.
- Jordan** (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Deut 34:9; Deut 1:38; Deut 31:23; Deut 31:3
- v2** — Deut 3:28; Deut 31:7
- v3** — Deut 11:24; Josh 14:9
- v4** — Ex 23:31; Gen 15:18-21
- v5** — Rom 8:31; Deut 31:6-8; Matt 28:20; Isa 41:10-14; Josh 1:9
- v6** — Dan 10:19; Eph 6:10; Josh 1:7; Josh 1:9; 1 Chr 22:13
- v7** — 1 Chr 22:13; Deut 5:32; Josh 1:8; Prov 4:27; Josh 11:15
- v8** — Ps 119:15; Ps 19:14; Col 3:16; Prov 3:1; Deut 29:9
- v9** — Gen 28:15; Jer 1:7-8; Ps 27:1-2; Josh 1:6-7; Deut 20:1
- v11** — Deut 9:1; Hos 6:2; 2 Kgs 20:5
- v13** — Num 32:20-28; Deut 3:18-20
- v17** — Josh 1:5

Chapter 2

Joshua sent two spies to Jericho, where the prostitute Rahab hid them from the king and confessed that the LORD had given Israel the land. The spies swore to spare Rahab and her family, instructing her to tie a scarlet cord in her window.

1	<i>And Joshua the son of Nun sent out of Shittim two men to spy secretly, saying, Go view the land, even Jericho. And they went, and came into an harlot's house, named Rahab, and lodged there.</i>	Joshua the son of Nun sent two men secretly from Shittim as spies, saying, "Go, view the land, especially Jericho." And they went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab and lodged there.
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Rahab** (RAY-hab) — "broad, spacious" — A prostitute of Jericho who hid the Israelite spies and confessed faith in the LORD. She and her family were spared when Jericho fell. She married Salmon, bore Boaz, and entered the lineage of Christ (Matthew 1:5; Hebrews 11:31).

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| <p>2 And it was told the king of Jericho, saying, Behold, there came men in hither to night of the children of Israel to search out the country.</p> | <p>it was told to the king of Jericho, "men of Israel have come here tonight to search out the land."</p> |
| <p>3 And the king of Jericho sent unto Rahab, saying, Bring forth the men that are come to thee, which are entered into thine house: for they be come to search out all the country.</p> | <p>Then the king of Jericho sent to Rahab, saying, "Bring out the men who have come to you, who entered your house, for they have come to search out all the land."</p> |
| <p>4 And the woman took the two men, and hid them, and said thus, There came men unto me, but I wist not whence they were:</p> | <p>But the woman had taken the two men and hidden them. And she said, "Yes, the men came to me. But I did not know where they were from."</p> |
| <p>5 And it came to pass about the time of shutting of the gate, when it was dark, that the men went out: whither the men went I wot not: pursue after them quickly; for ye shall overtake them.</p> | <p>when the gate was about to be closed at dark, the men went out. I do not know where the men went. Pursue them quickly, for you will overtake them."</p> |
| <p>6 But she had brought them up to the roof of the house, and hid them with the stalks of flax, which she had laid in order upon the roof.</p> | <p>But she had brought them up to the roof and hid them with the stalks of flax that she had laid in order on the roof.</p> |
| <p>7 And the men pursued after them the way to Jordan unto the fords: and as soon as they which pursued after them were gone out, they shut the gate.</p> | <p>So the men pursued after them on the way to the Jordan as far as the fords. And the gate was shut as soon as the pursuers had gone out.</p> |
| <p>8 And before they were laid down, she came up unto them upon the roof;</p> | <p>Before the men lay down, she came up to them on the roof</p> |

- 9 *And she said unto the men, I know that the LORD hath given you the land, and that your terror is fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land faint because of you.* said to the men, "I know that the LORD has given You the land, and that the fear of You has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before You.
- 10 *For we have heard how the LORD dried up the water of the Red sea for you, when ye came out of Egypt; and what ye did unto the two kings of the Amorites, that were on the other side Jordan, Sihon and Og, whom ye utterly destroyed.* For we have heard how the LORD dried up the water of the Red Sea before You when You came out of Egypt, and what You did to the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, to Sihon and Og, whom You devoted to destruction.
- 11 *And as soon as we had heard these things, our hearts did melt, neither did there remain any more courage in any man, because of you: for the LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and in earth beneath.* as soon as we heard it, our hearts melted, and there was no spirit left in any man because of You, for the LORD Your God, He is God in the heavens above and on the earth beneath.
- 12 *Now therefore, I pray you, swear unto me by the LORD, since I have shewed you kindness, that ye will also shew kindness unto my father's house, and give me a true token:* Now then, please swear to me by the LORD that, as I have dealt kindly with You, You also will deal kindly with my father's house, and give me a sure sign
- 13 *And that ye will save alive my father, and my mother, and my brethren, and my sisters, and all that they have, and deliver our lives from death.* that You will save alive my father and mother, my brothers and sisters, and all who belong to them, and deliver our lives from death."
- 14 *And the men answered her, Our life for yours, if ye utter not this our business. And it shall be, when the LORD hath given us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with thee.* the men said to her, "Our life for Yours even to death! If You do not tell this business of ours, then when the LORD gives us the land we will deal kindly and faithfully with You."

- 15 *Then she let them down by a cord through the window: for her house was upon the town wall, and she dwelt upon the wall.* Then she let them down by a rope through the window, for her house was built into the city wall, so that she lived in the wall.
- 16 *And she said unto them, Get you to the mountain, lest the pursuers meet you; and hide yourselves there three days, until the pursuers be returned: and afterward may ye go your way.* she said to them, "Go into the hills, or the pursuers will meet You, and hide there three days until the pursuers have returned. Then afterward You may go Your way."
- 17 *And the men said unto her, We will be blameless of this thine oath which thou hast made us swear.* The men said to her, "We will be guiltless with respect to this oath of Yours that You have made us swear.
- 18 *Behold, when we come into the land, thou shalt bind this line of scarlet thread in the window which thou didst let us down by: and thou shalt bring thy father, and thy mother, and thy brethren, and all thy father's household, home unto thee.* when we come into the land, You shall tie this scarlet cord in the window through which You let us down, and You shall gather into Your house Your father and mother, Your brothers, and all Your father's household.
- 19 *And it shall be, that whosoever shall go out of the doors of thy house into the street, his blood shall be upon his head, and we will be guiltless: and whosoever shall be with thee in the house, his blood shall be on our head, if any hand be upon him.* Then if anyone goes out of the doors of your house into the street, His blood shall be on His own head. We shall be guiltless. But if a hand is laid on anyone who is with you in the house, his blood shall be on our head.
- 20 *And if thou utter this our business, then we will be quit of thine oath which thou hast made us to swear.* But if You tell this business of ours, then we shall be guiltless with respect to Your oath that You have made us swear."
- 21 *And she said, According unto your words, so be it. And she sent them away, and they departed: and she bound the scarlet line in the window.* she said, "According to Your words, so be it." Then she sent them away. They departed. And she tied the scarlet cord in the window.

- 22 *And they went, and came unto the mountain, and abode there three days, until the pursuers were returned: and the pursuers sought them throughout all the way, but found them not.* They departed and went into the hills and remained there three days until the pursuers returned, and the pursuers searched all along the way and found nothing.
- 23 *So the two men returned, and descended from the mountain, and passed over, and came to Joshua the son of Nun, and told him all things that befell them:* Then the two men returned. They came down from the hills and passed over and came to Joshua the son of Nun. They told him all that had happened to them.
- 24 *And they said unto Joshua, Truly the LORD hath delivered into our hands all the land; for even all the inhabitants of the country do faint because of us.* they said to Joshua, "Truly the LORD has given all the land into our hands. And also, all the inhabitants of the land melt away because of us."

Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Heb 11:31; Jas 2:25; Matt 1:5

v6 — Jas 2:25; Heb 11:23

v9 — Ex 23:27; Deut 2:25

v10 — Num 21:21-35

v11 — Deut 4:39; Josh 5:1; Josh 7:5; Isa 13:7

v12 — Josh 2:18

v14 — Matt 5:7; Judg 1:24-25

v18 — Josh 6:23; Josh 2:21; Josh 2:12-13

v19 — Acts 27:31

Chapter 3

The priests carrying the ark of the covenant stepped into the Jordan, and the waters were cut off so that all Israel crossed on dry ground. God exalted Joshua in the sight of Israel, confirming his leadership as He had confirmed Moses.

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| 1 <i>And Joshua rose early in the morning; and they removed from Shittim, and came to Jordan, he and all the children of Israel, and lodged there before they passed over.</i> | Then Joshua rose early in the morning and they set out from Shittim. And they came to the Jordan, he and all the people of Israel, and lodged there before they passed over. |
| 2 <i>And it came to pass after three days, that the officers went through the host;</i> | At the end of three days the officers went through the camp |
| 3 <i>And they commanded the people, saying, When ye see the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, and the priests the Levites bearing it, then ye shall remove from your place, and go after it.</i> | commanded the people, "When you see the ark of the covenant of the LORD Your God being carried by the Levitical priests, then You shall set out from Your place and follow it. |
| 4 <i>Yet there shall be a space between you and it, about two thousand cubits by measure: come not near unto it, that ye may know the way by which ye must go: for ye have not passed this way heretofore.</i> | Yet there shall be a distance between You and it, about 2,000 cubits in length. Do not come near it, in order that You may know the way You shall go, for You have not passed this way before." |
| 5 <i>And Joshua said unto the people, Sanctify yourselves: for to morrow the LORD will do wonders among you.</i> | Joshua said to the people, "Consecrate yourselves, for tomorrow the LORD will do wonders among you." |
| 6 <i>And Joshua spake unto the priests, saying, Take up the ark of the covenant, and pass over before the people. And they took up the ark of the covenant, and went before the people.</i> | Joshua said to the priests, "Take up the ark of the covenant and pass on before the people." So they took up the ark of the covenant and went before the people. |

- 7 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, This day will I begin to magnify thee in the sight of all Israel, that they may know that, as I was with Moses, so I will be with thee.* The LORD said to Joshua, "Today I will begin to exalt you in the sight of all Israel, that they may know that, as I was with Moses, so I will be with you.
- 8 *And thou shalt command the priests that bear the ark of the covenant, saying, When ye are come to the brink of the water of Jordan, ye shall stand still in Jordan.* as for You, command the priests who bear the ark of the covenant, 'When You come to the edge of the waters of the Jordan, You shall stand still in the Jordan.' "
- 9 *And Joshua said unto the children of Israel, Come hither, and hear the words of the LORD your God.* Joshua said to the people of Israel, "Come here and listen to the words of the LORD Your God."
- 10 *And Joshua said, Hereby ye shall know that the living God is among you, and that he will without fail drive out from before you the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Hivites, and the Perizzites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Jebusites.* Joshua said, "Here is how you shall know that the living God is among you and that He will without fail drive out from before you the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Hivites, the Perizzites, the Girgashites, the Amorites, and the Jebusites.
- 11 *Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth passeth over before you into Jordan.* the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth is passing over before you into the Jordan.
- 12 *Now therefore take you twelve men out of the tribes of Israel, out of every tribe a man.* Now therefore take twelve men from the tribes of Israel, from each tribe a man.
- 13 *And it shall come to pass, as soon as the soles of the feet of the priests that bear the ark of the LORD, the Lord of all the earth, shall rest in the waters of Jordan, that the waters of Jordan shall be cut off from the waters that come down from above; and they shall stand upon an heap.* when the soles of the feet of the priests bearing the ark of the LORD, the Lord of all the earth, shall rest in the waters of the Jordan, the waters of the Jordan shall be cut off from flowing, and the waters coming down from above shall stand in one heap."

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| <p>14 <i>And it came to pass, when the people removed from their tents, to pass over Jordan, and the priests bearing the ark of the covenant before the people;</i></p> <p>15 <i>And as they that bare the ark were come unto Jordan, and the feet of the priests that bare the ark were dipped in the brim of the water, (for Jordan overfloweth all his banks all the time of harvest,)</i></p> <p>16 <i>That the waters which came down from above stood and rose up upon an heap very far from the city Adam, that is beside Zaretan: and those that came down toward the sea of the plain, even the salt sea, failed, and were cut off: and the people passed over right against Jericho.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the midst of Jordan, and all the Israelites passed over on dry ground, until all the people were passed clean over Jordan.</i></p> | <p>So when the people set out from their tents to pass over the Jordan with the priests bearing the ark of the covenant before the people,</p> <p>as soon as those bearing the ark had come as far as the Jordan, and the feet of the priests bearing the ark were dipped in the brink of the water (now the Jordan overflows all its banks throughout the time of harvest),</p> <p>the waters coming down from above stood and rose up in a heap very far away, at Adam, the city that is beside Zarethán, and those flowing down toward the Sea of the Arabah, the Salt Sea, were completely cut off. And the people passed over opposite Jericho.</p> <p>Now the priests bearing the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firmly on dry ground in the midst of the Jordan. All Israel was passing over on dry ground until all the nation had finished passing over the Jordan.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Girgashites (*GER-gah-shytes*) — One of the seven Canaanite nations — listed among the peoples that Israel displaced; little else is known about them beyond their name.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 2:1
- v3 — Deut 31:9
- v5 — Josh 7:13; Lev 20:7; Joel 2:16; 1 Sam 16:5; John 17:19
- v7 — Josh 4:14; Josh 1:5; 1 Chr 29:25; Ps 18:35; Phil 2:9-11
- v10 — Deut 7:1; Ex 33:2; Ps 44:2-3; Heb 10:31; 1 Sam 17:26
- v11 — Zech 6:5
- v12 — Josh 4:2
- v13 — Ex 15:8; Ps 78:13
- v15 — 1 Chr 12:15
- v16 — Josh 3:13
- v17 — Ex 14:29; Ex 14:22; Ps 66:6; Isa 25:8

Chapter 4

Twelve men, one from each tribe, took twelve stones from the middle of the Jordan as a memorial of the crossing. Israel encamped at Gilgal, and the stones were set up as a witness for future generations.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, when all the people were clean passed over Jordan, that the LORD spake unto Joshua, saying,</i> | When all the nation had finished passing over the Jordan, the LORD said to Joshua, |
| 2 | <i>Take you twelve men out of the people, out of every tribe a man,</i> | "Take twelve men from the people, from each tribe a man, |
| 3 | <i>And command ye them, saying, Take you hence out of the midst of Jordan, out of the place where the priests' feet stood firm, twelve stones, and ye shall carry them over with you, and leave them in the lodging place, where ye shall lodge this night.</i> | command them, saying, 'Take twelve stones from here out of the midst of the Jordan, from the very place where the priests' feet stood firmly, and bring them over with You and lay them down in the place where You lodge tonight.' " |

- 4 *Then Joshua called the twelve men, whom he had prepared of the children of Israel, out of every tribe a man:* Then Joshua called the twelve men from the people of Israel, whom he had appointed, a man from each tribe.
- 5 *And Joshua said unto them, Pass over before the ark of the LORD your God into the midst of Jordan, and take ye up every man of you a stone upon his shoulder, according unto the number of the tribes of the children of Israel:* Joshua said to them, "Pass on before the ark of the LORD Your God into the midst of the Jordan, and take up each of You a stone upon His shoulder, according to the number of the tribes of the people of Israel,
- 6 *That this may be a sign among you, that when your children ask their fathers in time to come, saying, What mean ye by these stones?* that this may be a sign among You. When Your children ask in time to come, 'What do those stones mean to You?'
- 7 *Then ye shall answer them, That the waters of Jordan were cut off before the ark of the covenant of the LORD; when it passed over Jordan, the waters of Jordan were cut off: and these stones shall be for a memorial unto the children of Israel for ever.* then You shall tell them that the waters of the Jordan were cut off before the ark of the covenant of the LORD. When it passed over the Jordan, the waters of the Jordan were cut off. So these stones shall be to the people of Israel a memorial forever."
- 8 *And the children of Israel did so as Joshua commanded, and took up twelve stones out of the midst of Jordan, as the LORD spake unto Joshua, according to the number of the tribes of the children of Israel, and carried them over with them unto the place where they lodged, and laid them down there.* the people of Israel did just as Joshua commanded and took up twelve stones out of the midst of the Jordan, according to the number of the tribes of the people of Israel, as the LORD told Joshua. And they carried them over with them to the place where they lodged and laid them down there.
- 9 *And Joshua set up twelve stones in the midst of Jordan, in the place where the feet of the priests which bare the ark of the covenant stood: and they are there unto this day.* Joshua set up twelve stones in the midst of the Jordan, in the place where the feet of the priests bearing the ark of the covenant had stood. They are there to this day.

- 10 *For the priests which bare the ark stood in the midst of Jordan, until every thing was finished that the LORD commanded Joshua to speak unto the people, according to all that Moses commanded Joshua: and the people hastened and passed over.* For the priests bearing the ark stood in the midst of the Jordan until everything was finished that the LORD commanded Joshua to tell the people, according to all that Moses had commanded Joshua. The people passed over in haste.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when all the people were clean passed over, that the ark of the LORD passed over, and the priests, in the presence of the people.* when all the people had finished passing over, the ark of the LORD and the priests passed over before the people.
- 12 *And the children of Reuben, and the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh, passed over armed before the children of Israel, as Moses spake unto them:* The sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh passed over armed before the people of Israel, as Moses had told them.
- 13 *About forty thousand prepared for war passed over before the LORD unto battle, to the plains of Jericho.* About 40,000 ready for war passed over before the LORD for battle, to the plains of Jericho.
- 14 *On that day the LORD magnified Joshua in the sight of all Israel; and they feared him, as they feared Moses, all the days of his life.* On that day the LORD exalted Joshua in the sight of all Israel. They stood in awe of Him just as they had stood in awe of Moses, all the days of his life.
- 15 *And the LORD spake unto Joshua, saying,* the LORD said to Joshua,
- 16 *Command the priests that bear the ark of the testimony, that they come up out of Jordan.* "Command the priests bearing the ark of the testimony to come up out of the Jordan."
- 17 *Joshua therefore commanded the priests, saying, Come ye up out of Jordan.* So Joshua commanded the priests, "Come up out of the Jordan."

- 18 *And it came to pass, when the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD were come up out of the midst of Jordan, and the soles of the priests' feet were lifted up unto the dry land, that the waters of Jordan returned unto their place, and flowed over all his banks, as they did before.* when the priests bearing the ark of the covenant of the LORD came up from the midst of the Jordan, and the soles of the priests' feet were lifted up on dry ground, the waters of the Jordan returned to their place and overflowed all its banks, as before.
- 19 *And the people came up out of Jordan on the tenth day of the first month, and encamped in Gilgal, in the east border of Jericho.* The people came up out of the Jordan on the tenth day of the first month. They encamped at Gilgal on the east border of Jericho.
- 20 *And those twelve stones, which they took out of Jordan, did Joshua pitch in Gilgal.* those twelve stones, which they had taken out of the Jordan, Joshua set up at Gilgal.
- 21 *And he spake unto the children of Israel, saying, When your children shall ask their fathers in time to come, saying, What mean these stones?* he said to the people of Israel, "When your children ask their fathers in times to come, 'What do these stones mean?'
- 22 *Then ye shall let your children know, saying, Israel came over this Jordan on dry land.* then you shall let your children know, 'Israel passed over this Jordan on dry ground.'
- 23 *For the LORD your God dried up the waters of Jordan from before you, until ye were passed over, as the LORD your God did to the Red sea, which he dried up from before us, until we were gone over:* For the LORD Your God dried up the waters of the Jordan for You until You passed over, as the LORD Your God did to the Red Sea, which He dried up for us until we passed over,
- 24 *That all the people of the earth might know the hand of the LORD, that it is mighty: that ye might fear the LORD your God for ever.* so that all the peoples of the earth may know that the hand of the LORD is mighty, that You may fear the LORD Your God forever."

Words in this chapter:

ark of the testimony — Another name for the ark of the covenant — 'testimony' refers to the tablets of the law stored inside it.

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 27:2

v2 — Josh 3:12

v3 — Josh 4:19-20

v6 — Ex 13:14; Josh 4:21; Ps 44:1; Deut 6:20-21

v7 — Ex 12:14

v14 — Josh 3:7; 2 Chr 30:12

v18 — Josh 3:15

v19 — Josh 5:9

v20 — Josh 4:8; Josh 4:3

v21 — Josh 4:6

v23 — Ex 14:21

v24 — Ps 106:8; 1 Kgs 8:42-43; Ps 89:13; Ex 15:16; 1 Chr 29:12

Chapter 5

Joshua circumcised the generation born in the wilderness, and Israel kept the Passover at Gilgal. The manna ceased, and the commander of the LORD's army appeared to Joshua near Jericho.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when all the kings of the Amorites, which were on the side of Jordan westward, and all the kings of the Canaanites, which were by the sea, heard that the LORD had dried up the waters of Jordan from before the children of Israel, until we were passed over, that their heart melted, neither was there spirit in them any more, because of the children of Israel.* As soon as all the kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan to the west, and all the kings of the Canaanites who were by the sea, heard that the LORD had dried up the waters of the Jordan before the people of Israel until they had crossed over, their hearts melted and there was no longer any spirit in them because of the people of Israel.

- 2 *At that time the LORD said unto Joshua, Make thee sharp knives, and circumcise again the children of Israel the second time.* At that time the LORD said to Joshua, "Make flint knives and circumcise the people of Israel again the second time."
- 3 *And Joshua made him sharp knives, and circumcised the children of Israel at the hill of the foreskins.* So Joshua made flint knives and circumcised the people of Israel at the hill of the foreskins.
- 4 *And this is the cause why Joshua did circumcise: All the people that came out of Egypt, that were males, even all the men of war, died in the wilderness by the way, after they came out of Egypt.* this is the reason why Joshua circumcised them: all the males of the people who came out of Egypt, all the men of war, had died in the wilderness on the way after they came out of Egypt.
- 5 *Now all the people that came out were circumcised: but all the people that were born in the wilderness by the way as they came forth out of Egypt, them they had not circumcised.* Though all the people who came out had been circumcised, yet all the people who were born on the way in the wilderness after they had come out of Egypt had not been circumcised.
- 6 *For the children of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness, till all the people that were men of war, which came out of Egypt, were consumed, because they obeyed not the voice of the LORD: unto whom the LORD sware that he would not shew them the land, which the LORD sware unto their fathers that he would give us, a land that floweth with milk and honey.* For the people of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness, until all the nation, the men of war who came out of Egypt, perished, because they did not obey the voice of the LORD; the LORD swore to them that He would not let them see the land that the LORD had sworn to their fathers to give to us, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 7 *And their children, whom he raised up in their stead, them Joshua circumcised: for they were uncircumcised, because they had not circumcised them by the way.* So it was their children, whom he raised up in their place, that Joshua circumcised. For they were uncircumcised, because they had not been circumcised on the way.

- 8 *And it came to pass, when they had done circumcising all the people, that they abode in their places in the camp, till they were whole.* When the circumcising of the whole nation was finished, they remained in their places in the camp until they were healed.
- 9 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, This day have I rolled away the reproach of Egypt from off you. Wherefore the name of the place is called Gilgal unto this day.* the LORD said to Joshua, "Today I have rolled away the reproach of Egypt from you." And so the name of that place is called Gilgal to this day.
- 10 *And the children of Israel encamped in Gilgal, and kept the passover on the fourteenth day of the month at even in the plains of Jericho.* While the people of Israel were encamped at Gilgal, they kept the Passover on the fourteenth day of the month in the evening on the plains of Jericho.
- 11 *And they did eat of the old corn of the land on the morrow after the passover, unleavened cakes, and parched corn in the selfsame day.* the day after the Passover, on that very day, they ate of the old corn of the land, unleavened cakes and parched corn.
- 12 *And the manna ceased on the morrow after they had eaten of the old corn of the land; neither had the children of Israel manna any more; but they did eat of the fruit of the land of Canaan that year.* the manna ceased the day after they ate of the old corn of the land. And there was no longer manna for the people of Israel. But they ate of the fruit of the land of Canaan that year.
- 13 *And it came to pass, when Joshua was by Jericho, that he lifted up his eyes and looked, and, behold, there stood a man over against him with his sword drawn in his hand: and Joshua went unto him, and said unto him, Art thou for us, or for our adversaries?* When Joshua was by Jericho, he lifted up his eyes and looked, and a man was standing before him with his drawn sword in his hand. And Joshua went to him and said to him, "Are you for us, or for our adversaries?"

- 14

And he said, Nay; but as captain of the host of the LORD am I now come. And Joshua fell on his face to the earth, and did worship, and said unto him, What saith my lord unto his servant?

he said, "No; but I am the commander of the army of the LORD. Now I have come." And Joshua fell on his face to the earth and worshiped and said to Him, "What does my lord say to His servant?"
- 15

And the captain of the LORD's host said unto Joshua, Loose thy shoe from off thy foot; for the place whereon thou standest is holy. And Joshua did so.

the commander of the LORD's army said to Joshua, "Take off your sandals from your feet, for the place where you are standing is holy." And Joshua did so.

Words in this chapter:

- passover** — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.
- Canaan** (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 2:9-11
- v2 — Deut 10:16; Deut 30:6; Ex 4:25
- v6 — Num 14:23; Deut 2:14; Heb 3:11; Deut 1:3; Ps 95:10-11
- v9 — 1 Sam 17:26; Josh 4:19; Gen 34:14
- v12 — Ex 16:35; Neh 9:20-21; Deut 6:10-11; Rev 7:16-17; Isa 65:13-14
- v13 — Gen 18:2; Num 22:23; Num 22:31; 1 Chr 21:16-17; 1 Chr 21:30
- v14 — Isa 55:4; Gen 17:3; Ex 23:20-22; Rev 19:10-14; Acts 10:25-26
- v15 — Ex 3:5; Acts 7:32-33

Chapter 6

Israel marched around Jericho once a day for six days, and seven times on the seventh day, after which the walls fell flat at the sound of the trumpets and the people's shout. The city was devoted to destruction, but Rahab and her family were spared.

- 1

Now Jericho was straitly shut up because of the children of Israel: none went out, and none came in.

Now Jericho was shut up inside and outside because of the people of Israel. None went out, and none came in.

- 2 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, See, I have given into thine hand Jericho, and the king thereof, and the mighty men of valour.* the LORD said to Joshua, "See, I have given Jericho into your hand, with its king and mighty men of valor.
- 3 *And ye shall compass the city, all ye men of war, and go round about the city once. Thus shalt thou do six days.* You shall march around the city, all the men of war going around the city once. Thus shall You do for six days.
- 4 *And seven priests shall bear before the ark seven trumpets of rams' horns: and the seventh day ye shall compass the city seven times, and the priests shall blow with the trumpets.* Seven priests shall bear seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark. On the seventh day You shall march around the city seven times, and the priests shall blow the trumpets.
- 5 *And it shall come to pass, that when they make a long blast with the ram's horn, and when ye hear the sound of the trumpet, all the people shall shout with a great shout; and the wall of the city shall fall down flat, and the people shall ascend up every man straight before him.* when they make a long blast with the ram's horn, when You hear the sound of the trumpet, then all the people shall shout with a great shout, and the wall of the city will fall down flat, and the people shall go up, everyone straight before him."
- 6 *And Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said unto them, Take up the ark of the covenant, and let seven priests bear seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD.* So Joshua the son of Nun called the priests and said to them, "Take up the ark of the covenant and let seven priests bear seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD."
- 7 *And he said unto the people, Pass on, and compass the city, and let him that is armed pass on before the ark of the LORD.* he said to the people, "Go forward. March around the city and let the armed men pass on before the ark of the LORD."

- 8 *And it came to pass, when Joshua had spoken unto the people, that the seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams' horns passed on before the LORD, and blew with the trumpets: and the ark of the covenant of the LORD followed them.* just as Joshua had commanded the people, the seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams' horns before the LORD went forward, blowing the trumpets, with the ark of the covenant of the LORD following them.
- 9 *And the armed men went before the priests that blew with the trumpets, and the rearward came after the ark, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets.* The armed men were walking before the priests who were blowing the trumpets, and the rear guard was walking after the ark, while the trumpets blew continually.
- 10 *And Joshua had commanded the people, saying, Ye shall not shout, nor make any noise with your voice, neither shall any word proceed out of your mouth, until the day I bid you shout; then shall ye shout.* But Joshua commanded the people, "You shall not shout or make your voice heard, neither shall any word go out of your mouth, until the day I tell you to shout. Then you shall shout."
- 11 *So the ark of the LORD compassed the city, going about it once: and they came into the camp, and lodged in the camp.* So He caused the ark of the LORD to circle the city, going about it once. And they came into the camp and spent the night in the camp.
- 12 *And Joshua rose early in the morning, and the priests took up the ark of the LORD.* Then Joshua rose early in the morning, and the priests took up the ark of the LORD.
- 13 *And seven priests bearing seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD went on continually, and blew with the trumpets: and the armed men went before them; but the rearward came after the ark of the LORD, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets.* the seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD walked on. They blew the trumpets continually. And the armed men were walking before them, and the rear guard was walking after the ark of the LORD, while the trumpets blew continually.

- 14 *And the second day they compassed the city once, and returned into the camp: so they did six days.* the second day they marched around the city once, and returned into the camp. So they did for six days.
- 15 *And it came to pass on the seventh day, that they rose early about the dawning of the day, and compassed the city after the same manner seven times: only on that day they compassed the city seven times.* On the seventh day they rose early, at the dawn of day, and marched around the city in the same manner seven times. It was only on that day that they marched around the city seven times.
- 16 *And it came to pass at the seventh time, when the priests blew with the trumpets, Joshua said unto the people, Shout; for the LORD hath given you the city.* at the seventh time, when the priests had blown the trumpets, Joshua said to the people, "Shout, for the LORD has given you the city.
- 17 *And the city shall be accursed, even it, and all that are therein, to the LORD: only Rahab the harlot shall live, she and all that are with her in the house, because she hid the messengers that we sent.* the city and all that is within it shall be devoted to the LORD for destruction. Only Rahab the prostitute and all who are with her in her house shall live, because she hid the messengers whom we sent.
- 18 *And ye, in any wise keep yourselves from the accursed thing, lest ye make yourselves accursed, when ye take of the accursed thing, and make the camp of Israel a curse, and trouble it.* But You, keep yourselves from the things devoted to destruction, lest when You have devoted them You take any of the devoted things and make the camp of Israel a thing for destruction and bring trouble upon it.
- 19 *But all the silver, and gold, and vessels of brass and iron, are consecrated unto the LORD: they shall come into the treasury of the LORD.* But all silver and gold, and every vessel of bronze and iron, are holy to the LORD; they shall go into the treasury of the LORD."

- 20 *So the people shouted when the priests blew with the trumpets: and it came to pass, when the people heard the sound of the trumpet, and the people shouted with a great shout, that the wall fell down flat, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight before him, and they took the city.* So the people shouted, and the trumpets were blown. As soon as the people heard the sound of the trumpet, the people shouted a great shout, and the wall fell down flat, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight before him. They captured the city.
- 21 *And they utterly destroyed all that was in the city, both man and woman, young and old, and ox, and sheep, and ass, with the edge of the sword.* Then they devoted all in the city to destruction, both men and women, young and old, oxen, sheep, and donkeys, with the edge of the sword.
- 22 *But Joshua had said unto the two men that had spied out the country, Go into the harlot's house, and bring out thence the woman, and all that she hath, as ye sware unto her.* But to the two men who had spied out the land, Joshua said, "Go into the prostitute's house and bring out from there the woman and all who belong to her, as you swore to her."
- 23 *And the young men that were spies went in, and brought out Rahab, and her father, and her mother, and her brethren, and all that she had; and they brought out all her kindred, and left them without the camp of Israel.* So the young men who had been spies went in and brought out Rahab and her father and mother and brothers and all who belonged to her. And they brought all her relatives and put them outside the camp of Israel.
- 24 *And they burnt the city with fire, and all that was therein: only the silver, and the gold, and the vessels of brass and of iron, they put into the treasury of the house of the LORD.* they burned the city with fire, and everything in it. Only the silver and gold, and the vessels of bronze and of iron, they put into the treasury of the house of the LORD.
- 25 *And Joshua saved Rahab the harlot alive, and her father's household, and all that she had; and she dwelleth in Israel even unto this day; because she hid the messengers, which Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.* But Rahab the prostitute and her father's household and all who belonged to her, Joshua saved alive. And she has lived in Israel to this day, because she hid the messengers whom Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.

- 26 *And Joshua adjured them at that time, saying, Cursed be the man before the LORD, that riseth up and buildeth this city Jericho: he shall lay the foundation thereof in his firstborn, and in his youngest son shall he set up the gates of it.* Joshua laid an oath on them at that time, saying, "Cursed before the LORD be the man who rises up and rebuilds this city, Jericho. At the cost of His firstborn shall He lay its foundation, and at the cost of His youngest son shall He set up its gates."
- 27 *So the LORD was with Joshua; and his fame was noised throughout all the country.* So the LORD was with Joshua. His fame was in all the land.

Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 2:24; Josh 2:9-14; Ps 127:1
v2 — Deut 7:24; Josh 8:1; Josh 2:24; Josh 2:9
v4 — 2 Chr 20:17; Rev 16:1; 1 Kgs 18:43; Rev 8:2
v5 — 2 Cor 10:4-5; Heb 11:30; Ex 19:19; 1 Sam 4:5; 2 Chr 13:14-15
v13 — Gal 6:9; Matt 24:13
v18 — 1 John 5:21; Eph 5:11; Josh 7:11-12; Josh 7:1; Josh 7:25
v19 — Matt 27:6; 1 Chr 26:20
v20 — Heb 11:30; 2 Cor 10:4-5; Josh 6:5
v22 — Heb 11:31
v25 — Heb 11:31; Matt 1:5; Josh 2:6; Jas 2:25; Judg 1:24-25
v26 — 1 Kgs 16:34; Acts 19:13
v27 — Josh 9:3; Josh 1:5; Matt 18:20; Matt 28:20; Josh 9:1

Chapter 7

Achan took devoted things from Jericho, and Israel was defeated at Ai with thirty-six men killed. God revealed Achan's sin by lot, and Achan and all he had were stoned and burned in the Valley of Achor.

- 1 *But the children of Israel committed a trespass in the accursed thing: for Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, took of the accursed thing: and the anger of the LORD was kindled against the children of Israel.* But the people of Israel broke faith in regard to the devoted things, for Achan the son of Carmi, son of Zabdi, son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, took some of the devoted things. And the anger of the LORD burned against the people of Israel.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Achan** (AY-kan) — "troubler" — A man of the tribe of Judah who secretly took plunder from Jericho that God had devoted to destruction. His sin caused Israel's defeat at Ai and brought judgment on his entire household. The Valley of Achor ("trouble") is named after him.

- 2 *And Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is beside Bethaven, on the east side of Bethel, and spake unto them, saying, Go up and view the country. And the men went up and viewed Ai.* Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is near Beth-aven, east of Bethel, and said to them, "Go up and spy out the land." And the men went up and spied out Ai.
- 3 *And they returned to Joshua, and said unto him, Let not all the people go up; but let about two or three thousand men go up and smite Ai; and make not all the people to labour thither; for they are but few.* they returned to Joshua and said to him, "Do not have all the people go up, but let about two or three thousand men go up and attack Ai. Do not make the whole people toil up there, for they are few."
- 4 *So there went up thither of the people about three thousand men: and they fled before the men of Ai.* So about three thousand men went up there from the people. And they fled before the men of Ai,
- 5 *And the men of Ai smote of them about thirty and six men: for they chased them from before the gate even unto Shebarim, and smote them in the going down: wherefore the hearts of the people melted, and became as water.* the men of Ai killed about thirty-six of their men and chased them before the gate as far as Shebarim and struck them at the descent. And the hearts of the people melted and became as water.

- 6 *And Joshua rent his clothes, and fell to the earth upon his face before the ark of the LORD until the eventide, he and the elders of Israel, and put dust upon their heads.* Then Joshua tore his clothes and fell to the earth on his face before the ark of the LORD until the evening, He and the elders of Israel. And they put dust on their heads.
- 7 *And Joshua said, Alas, O Lord GOD, wherefore hast thou at all brought this people over Jordan, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us? would to God we had been content, and dwelt on the other side Jordan!* Joshua said, "Alas, O Lord GOD, why have You brought this people over the Jordan at all, to give us into the hands of the Amorites, to destroy us? Would that we had been content to dwell beyond the Jordan!
- 8 *O Lord, what shall I say, when Israel turneth their backs before their enemies!* O Lord, what can I say, when Israel has turned its backs before its enemies!
- 9 *For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land shall hear of it, and shall environ us round, and cut off our name from the earth: and what wilt thou do unto thy great name?* For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land will hear of it and will surround us and cut off our name from the earth. And what will You do for Your great name?"
- 10 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Get thee up; wherefore liest thou thus upon thy face?* The LORD said to Joshua, "Get up! Why have you fallen on your face?
- 11 *Israel hath sinned, and they have also transgressed my covenant which I commanded them: for they have even taken of the accursed thing, and have also stolen, and dissembled also, and they have put it even among their own stuff.* Israel has sinned; they have transgressed my covenant that I commanded them; they have taken some of the devoted things; they have stolen and lied and put them among their own belongings.

- 12 *Therefore the children of Israel could not stand before their enemies, but turned their backs before their enemies, because they were accursed: neither will I be with you any more, except ye destroy the accursed from among you.* Therefore the people of Israel cannot stand before their enemies. They turn their backs before their enemies, because they have become devoted for destruction. I will be with You no more, unless You destroy the devoted things from among You.
- 13 *Up, sanctify the people, and say, Sanctify yourselves against to morrow: for thus saith the LORD God of Israel, There is an accursed thing in the midst of thee, O Israel: thou canst not stand before thine enemies, until ye take away the accursed thing from among you.* Get up! Consecrate the people and say, 'Consecrate yourselves for tomorrow; for thus says the LORD, God of Israel, "There are devoted things in Your midst, O Israel. You cannot stand before your enemies until you take away the devoted things from among You."
- 14 *In the morning therefore ye shall be brought according to your tribes: and it shall be, that the tribe which the LORD taketh shall come according to the families thereof; and the family which the LORD shall take shall come by households; and the household which the LORD shall take shall come man by man.* In the morning You shall be brought near by Your tribes. And the tribe that the LORD takes by lot shall come near by clans. And the clan that the LORD takes shall come near by households. And the household that the LORD takes shall come near man by man.
- 15 *And it shall be, that he that is taken with the accursed thing shall be burnt with fire, he and all that he hath: because he hath transgressed the covenant of the LORD, and because he hath wrought folly in Israel.* he who is taken with the devoted things shall be burned with fire, He and all that He has, because He has transgressed the covenant of the LORD, and because He has done an outrageous thing in Israel.' "
- 16 *So Joshua rose up early in the morning, and brought Israel by their tribes; and the tribe of Judah was taken:* So Joshua rose early in the morning and brought Israel near tribe by tribe, and the tribe of Judah was taken.

- 17 *And he brought the family of Judah; and he took the family of the Zarahites: and he brought the family of the Zarahites man by man; and Zabdi was taken:* he brought near the clans of Judah, and the clan of the Zerahites was taken. And he brought near the clan of the Zerahites man by man, and Zabdi was taken.
- 18 *And he brought his household man by man; and Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was taken.* he brought near his household man by man, and Achan the son of Carmi, son of Zabdi, son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was taken.
- 19 *And Joshua said unto Achan, My son, give, I pray thee, glory to the LORD God of Israel, and make confession unto him; and tell me now what thou hast done; hide it not from me.* Then Joshua said to Achan, "My son, give glory to the LORD God of Israel and give praise to Him. And tell me now what You have done; do not hide it from me."
- 20 *And Achan answered Joshua, and said, Indeed I have sinned against the LORD God of Israel, and thus and thus have I done:* Achan answered Joshua, "Truly I have sinned against the LORD God of Israel, and this is what I did:
- 21 *When I saw among the spoils a goodly Babylonish garment, and two hundred shekels of silver, and a wedge of gold of fifty shekels weight, then I coveted them, and took them; and, behold, they are hid in the earth in the midst of my tent, and the silver under it.* when I saw among the spoil a beautiful Babylonish garment, and 200 shekels of silver, and a bar of gold weighing 50 shekels, then I coveted them and took them. And see, they are hidden in the earth inside my tent, with the silver underneath."
- 22 *So Joshua sent messengers, and they ran unto the tent; and, behold, it was hid in his tent, and the silver under it.* So Joshua sent messengers. They ran to the tent. It was hidden in his tent with the silver underneath.
- 23 *And they took them out of the midst of the tent, and brought them unto Joshua, and unto all the children of Israel, and laid them out before the LORD.* they took them out of the tent and brought them to Joshua and to all the people of Israel. And they laid them down before the LORD.

- 24 *And Joshua, and all Israel with him, took Achan the son of Zerah, and the silver, and the garment, and the wedge of gold, and his sons, and his daughters, and his oxen, and his asses, and his sheep, and his tent, and all that he had: and they brought them unto the valley of Achor.* Joshua and all Israel with him took Achan the son of Zerah, and the silver and the cloak and the bar of gold, and his sons and daughters and his oxen and donkeys and sheep and his tent and all that he had. And they brought them up to the Valley of Achor.
- 25 *And Joshua said, Why hast thou troubled us? the LORD shall trouble thee this day. And all Israel stoned him with stones, and burned them with fire, after they had stoned them with stones.* Joshua said, "Why did you bring trouble on us? The LORD brings trouble on You today." And all Israel stoned Him with stones. They burned them with fire and stoned them with stones.
- 26 *And they raised over him a great heap of stones unto this day; so the LORD turned from the fierceness of his anger. Wherefore the name of that place was called, The valley of Achor, unto this day.* they raised over Him a great heap of stones that remains to this day. Then the LORD turned from His burning anger. Therefore, to this day the name of that place is called the Valley of Achor.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

v1 — Josh 22:20; Eccl 9:18; 1 Chr 2:6-7; Josh 22:18; Josh 7:20-21

v4 — Deut 28:25; Lev 26:17

v5 — Josh 2:11; Josh 2:9

v6 — Gen 37:29; Gen 37:34

v9 — Ex 32:12; Ezek 36:22-23; Ps 83:4

v10 — 1 Sam 16:1; Ex 14:15

v11 — Acts 5:1-2; Josh 6:17-19; Heb 4:13

v12 — Ps 5:4-5; Isa 59:2

v13 — Lam 3:40-41; Josh 3:5

v19 — 1 Sam 6:5; Jer 13:16; John 9:24

v21 — Jas 1:15; Luke 12:15; Ps 119:37; 1 John 2:15-16

v25 — Josh 6:18; 1 Chr 2:7

Chapter 8

Israel defeated Ai using an ambush strategy commanded by the LORD, killing all 12,000 inhabitants and hanging the king. Joshua then built an altar on Mount Ebal and read the entire law before all Israel.

- 1 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Fear not, neither be thou dismayed: take all the people of war with thee, and arise, go up to Ai: see, I have given into thy hand the king of Ai, and his people, and his city, and his land:* the LORD said to Joshua, "Do not fear and do not be dismayed. Take all the fighting men with you, and arise, go up to Ai. See, I have given into your hand the king of Ai, and his people, and his city, and his land.
- 2 *And thou shalt do to Ai and her king as thou didst unto Jericho and her king: only the spoil thereof, and the cattle thereof, shall ye take for a prey unto yourselves: lay thee an ambush for the city behind it.* you shall do to Ai and its king as You did to Jericho and its king. Only its spoil and its livestock You shall take as plunder for yourselves. Lay an ambush against the city, behind it."
- 3 *So Joshua arose, and all the people of war, to go up against Ai: and Joshua chose out thirty thousand mighty men of valour, and sent them away by night.* So Joshua and all the fighting men arose to go up to Ai. And Joshua chose 30,000 mighty men of valor and sent them out by night.
- 4 *And he commanded them, saying, Behold, ye shall lie in wait against the city, even behind the city: go not very far from the city, but be ye all ready:* he commanded them, " you shall lie in ambush against the city, behind it. Do not go very far from the city. But all of you remain ready.
- 5 *And I, and all the people that are with me, will approach unto the city: and it shall come to pass, when they come out against us, as at the first, that we will flee before them,* I and all the people who are with me will approach the city. And when they come out against us just as before, we shall flee before them.

- 6 *(For they will come out after us) till we have drawn them from the city; for they will say, They flee before us, as at the first: therefore we will flee before them.* they will come out after us, until we have drawn them away from the city. For they will say, 'They are fleeing from us, just as before.' So we will flee before them.
- 7 *Then ye shall rise up from the ambush, and seize upon the city: for the LORD your God will deliver it into your hand.* Then You shall rise up from the ambush and seize the city, for the LORD Your God will give it into Your hand.
- 8 *And it shall be, when ye have taken the city, that ye shall set the city on fire: according to the commandment of the LORD shall ye do. See, I have commanded you.* as soon as You have taken the city, You shall set the city on fire. You shall do according to the word of the LORD. See, I have commanded You."
- 9 *Joshua therefore sent them forth: and they went to lie in ambush, and abode between Bethel and Ai, on the west side of Ai: but Joshua lodged that night among the people.* So Joshua sent them out. And they went to the place of ambush and lay between Bethel and Ai, to the west of Ai, while Joshua spent that night among the people.
- 10 *And Joshua rose up early in the morning, and numbered the people, and went up, he and the elders of Israel, before the people to Ai.* Joshua arose early in the morning and mustered the people and went up, he and the elders of Israel, before the people to Ai.
- 11 *And all the people, even the people of war that were with him, went up, and drew nigh, and came before the city, and pitched on the north side of Ai: now there was a valley between them and Ai.* all the fighting men who were with him went up and drew near before the city and encamped on the north side of Ai, with a valley between them and Ai.
- 12 *And he took about five thousand men, and set them to lie in ambush between Bethel and Ai, on the west side of the city.* He took about 5,000 men and set them in ambush between Bethel and Ai, to the west of the city.

- 13 *And when they had set the people, even all the host that was on the north of the city, and their liers in wait on the west of the city, Joshua went that night into the midst of the valley.* So they stationed the forces, the main encampment that was north of the city and its rear guard west of the city. But Joshua spent that night in the valley.
- 14 *And it came to pass, when the king of Ai saw it, that they hasted and rose up early, and the men of the city went out against Israel to battle, he and all his people, at a time appointed, before the plain; but he wist not that there were liers in ambush against him behind the city.* as soon as the king of Ai saw this, he and all his people, the men of the city, hurried and went out early to the appointed place before the Arabah to meet Israel in battle. But he did not know that there was an ambush against him behind the city.
- 15 *And Joshua and all Israel made as if they were beaten before them, and fled by the way of the wilderness.* Joshua and all Israel pretended to be beaten before them and fled in the direction of the wilderness.
- 16 *And all the people that were in Ai were called together to pursue after them: and they pursued after Joshua, and were drawn away from the city.* So all the people who were in the city were called together to pursue them, and as they pursued Joshua they were drawn away from the city.
- 17 *And there was not a man left in Ai or Bethel, that went not out after Israel: and they left the city open, and pursued after Israel.* Not a man was left in Ai or Bethel who did not go out after Israel. They left the city open and pursued Israel.
- 18 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Stretch out the spear that is in thy hand toward Ai; for I will give it into thine hand. And Joshua stretched out the spear that he had in his hand toward the city.* Then the LORD said to Joshua, "Stretch out the javelin that is in your hand toward Ai, for I will give it into your hand." And Joshua stretched out the javelin that was in his hand toward the city.
- 19 *And the ambush arose quickly out of their place, and they ran as soon as he had stretched out his hand: and they entered into the city, and took it, and hasted and set the city on fire.* the men in the ambush rose quickly out of their place, and as soon as He had stretched out His hand, they ran and entered the city and captured it. And they hurried to set the city on fire.

- 20 *And when the men of Ai looked behind them, they saw, and, behold, the smoke of the city ascended up to heaven, and they had no power to flee this way or that way: and the people that fled to the wilderness turned back upon the pursuers.* So when the men of Ai looked back, they saw the smoke of the city going up to heaven. They had no power to flee this way or that way. And the people who fled to the wilderness turned back against the pursuers.
- 21 *And when Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city, and that the smoke of the city ascended, then they turned again, and slew the men of Ai.* when Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had captured the city, and that the smoke of the city went up, then they turned back and struck down the men of Ai.
- 22 *And the other issued out of the city against them; so they were in the midst of Israel, some on this side, and some on that side: and they smote them, so that they let none of them remain or escape.* the others came out from the city against them, so they were in the midst of Israel, some on this side and some on that side, and Israel struck them down, until there was left none that survived or escaped.
- 23 *And the king of Ai they took alive, and brought him to Joshua.* But the king of Ai they took alive, and brought him near to Joshua.
- 24 *And it came to pass, when Israel had made an end of slaying all the inhabitants of Ai in the field, in the wilderness wherein they chased them, and when they were all fallen on the edge of the sword, until they were consumed, that all the Israelites returned unto Ai, and smote it with the edge of the sword.* When Israel had finished killing all the inhabitants of Ai in the open wilderness where they pursued them, all of them to the very last had fallen by the edge of the sword, all Israel returned to Ai and struck it down with the edge of the sword.
- 25 *And so it was, that all that fell that day, both of men and women, were twelve thousand, even all the men of Ai.* all who fell that day, both men and women, were 12,000, all the people of Ai.

- 26 *For Joshua drew not his hand back, wherewith he stretched out the spear, until he had utterly destroyed all the inhabitants of Ai.* For Joshua did not draw back his hand with which he stretched out the javelin until he had devoted all the inhabitants of Ai to destruction.
- 27 *Only the cattle and the spoil of that city Israel took for a prey unto themselves, according unto the word of the LORD which he commanded Joshua.* Only the livestock and the spoil of that city Israel took as their plunder, according to the word of the LORD that He commanded Joshua.
- 28 *And Joshua burnt Ai, and made it an heap for ever, even a desolation unto this day.* So Joshua burned Ai and made it forever a heap of ruins, as it is to this day.
- 29 *And the king of Ai he hanged on a tree until eventide: and as soon as the sun was down, Joshua commanded that they should take his carcase down from the tree, and cast it at the entering of the gate of the city, and raise thereon a great heap of stones, that remaineth unto this day.* he hanged the king of Ai on a tree until evening. And at sunset Joshua commanded, and they took his body down from the tree and threw it at the entrance of the gate of the city and raised over it a great heap of stones, which stands there to this day.
- 30 *Then Joshua built an altar unto the LORD God of Israel in mount Ebal,* At that time Joshua built an altar to the LORD, the God of Israel, on Mount Ebal,
- 31 *As Moses the servant of the LORD commanded the children of Israel, as it is written in the book of the law of Moses, an altar of whole stones, over which no man hath lift up any iron: and they offered thereon burnt offerings unto the LORD, and sacrificed peace offerings.* just as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded the people of Israel, as it is written in the Book of the Law of Moses, "an altar of uncut stones, upon which no man has wielded an iron tool." And they offered on it burnt offerings to the LORD and sacrificed peace offerings.
- 32 *And he wrote there upon the stones a copy of the law of Moses, which he wrote in the presence of the children of Israel.* there, in the presence of the people of Israel, he wrote on the stones a copy of the law of Moses, which he had written.

- 33 *And all Israel, and their elders, and officers, and their judges, stood on this side the ark and on that side before the priests the Levites, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, as well the stranger, as he that was born among them; half of them over against mount Gerizim, and half of them over against mount Ebal; as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded before, that they should bless the people of Israel.* all Israel, sojourner as well as native born, with their elders and officers and their judges, stood on opposite sides of the ark before the Levitical priests who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD, half of them in front of Mount Gerizim and half of them in front of Mount Ebal, just as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded at the first, to bless the people of Israel.
- 34 *And afterward he read all the words of the law, the blessings and cursings, according to all that is written in the book of the law.* afterward He read all the words of the law, the blessing and the curse, according to all that is written in the Book of the Law.
- 35 *There was not a word of all that Moses commanded, which Joshua read not before all the congregation of Israel, with the women, and the little ones, and the strangers that were conversant among them.* There was not a word of all that Moses commanded that Joshua did not read before all the assembly of Israel, and the women, and the little ones, and the sojourners who lived among them.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Cross-References:

v1 — Josh 1:9; Deut 1:21; Deut 7:18; Deut 31:8; Josh 6:2

v2 — Deut 20:14

v18 — Josh 8:26

v22 — Deut 7:2

v26 — Ex 17:11-12

v27 — Josh 8:2

v28 — Deut 13:16

v30 — Deut 27:4-6

v31 — Deut 27:5-7; Ex 20:24-25

v33 — Deut 11:29; Deut 31:12

v35 — Deut 31:12

Chapter 9

The Gibeonites deceived Joshua and the leaders into making a peace treaty by pretending to be from a distant land. When the deception was discovered three days later, Israel honored the oath but made the Gibeonites woodcutters and water carriers.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, when all the kings which were on this side Jordan, in the hills, and in the valleys, and in all the coasts of the great sea over against Lebanon, the Hittite, and the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, heard thereof;</i></p> | <p>As soon as all the kings who were beyond the Jordan in the hill country and in the lowland and all along the coast of the Great Sea toward Lebanon, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Canaanites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, heard of this,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>That they gathered themselves together, to fight with Joshua and with Israel, with one accord.</i></p> | <p>they gathered together as one to fight against Joshua and Israel.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done unto Jericho and to Ai,</i></p> | <p>But when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done to Jericho and to Ai,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>They did work wilily, and went and made as if they had been ambassadors, and took old sacks upon their asses, and wine bottles, old, and rent, and bound up;</i></p> | <p>they on their part acted with cunning and went and made ready provisions and took worn-out sacks for their donkeys, and wineskins, worn-out and torn and mended,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And old shoes and clouted upon their feet, and old garments upon them; and all the bread of their provision was dry and mouldy.</i></p> | <p>with worn-out, patched sandals on their feet, and worn-out clothes. And all their provisions were dry and crumbly.</p> |

- 6 *And they went to Joshua unto the camp at Gilgal, and said unto him, and to the men of Israel, We be come from a far country: now therefore make ye a league with us.* they went to Joshua in the camp at Gilgal and said to him and to the men of Israel, "We have come from a distant country, so now make a covenant with us."
- 7 *And the men of Israel said unto the Hivites, Peradventure ye dwell among us; and how shall we make a league with you?* But the men of Israel said to the Hivites, "Perhaps you live among us; then how can we make a covenant with you?"
- 8 *And they said unto Joshua, We are thy servants. And Joshua said unto them, Who are ye? and from whence come ye?* They said to Joshua, "We are your servants." And Joshua said to them, "Who are you? And where do you come from?"
- 9 *And they said unto him, From a very far country thy servants are come, because of the name of the LORD thy God: for we have heard the fame of him, and all that he did in Egypt,* They said to Him, "From a very distant country Your servants have come, because of the name of the LORD Your God. For we have heard a report of Him. All that He did in Egypt,
- 10 *And all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites, that were beyond Jordan, to Sihon king of Heshbon, and to Og king of Bashan, which was at Asaroth.* all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, Sihon the king of Heshbon, and Og king of Bashan, who lived in Ashtaroth.
- 11 *Wherefore our elders and all the inhabitants of our country spake to us, saying, Take victuals with you for the journey, and go to meet them, and say unto them, We are your servants: therefore now make ye a league with us.* So our elders and all the inhabitants of our country said to us, "Take provisions in your hand for the journey and go to meet them and say to them, "We are your servants. Come now, make a covenant with us.""
- 12 *This our bread we took hot for our provision out of our houses on the day we came forth to go unto you; and now, behold, it is dry, and it is mouldy:* Here is our bread. It was still warm when we took it from our houses as our food for the journey on the day we set out to come to you, but now, it is dry and crumbly.

- 13 *And these bottles of wine, which we filled, were new; and, behold, they be rent: and these our garments and our shoes are become old by reason of the very long journey.* These wineskins were new when we filled them. They have burst. And these garments and sandals of ours are worn out from the very long journey."
- 14 *And the men took of their victuals, and asked not counsel at the mouth of the LORD.* So the men took some of their provisions, but did not ask counsel from the LORD.
- 15 *And Joshua made peace with them, and made a league with them, to let them live: and the princes of the congregation sware unto them.* Joshua made peace with them and made a covenant with them, to let them live, and the leaders of the congregation swore to them.
- 16 *And it came to pass at the end of three days after they had made a league with them, that they heard that they were their neighbours, and that they dwelt among them.* At the end of three days after they had made a covenant with them, they heard that they were their neighbors and that they lived among them.
- 17 *And the children of Israel journeyed, and came unto their cities on the third day. Now their cities were Gibeon, and Chephirah, and Beeroth, and Kirjathjearim.* the people of Israel set out and reached their cities on the third day. Now their cities were Gibeon, Chephirah, Beeroth, and Kiriath-jearim.
- 18 *And the children of Israel smote them not, because the princes of the congregation had sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel. And all the congregation murmured against the princes.* But the people of Israel did not attack them, because the leaders of the congregation had sworn to them by the LORD, the God of Israel. Then all the congregation murmured against the leaders.
- 19 *But all the princes said unto all the congregation, We have sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel: now therefore we may not touch them.* But all the leaders said to all the congregation, "We have sworn to them by the LORD, the God of Israel, and now we may not touch them.

- 20 *This we will do to them; we will even let them live, lest wrath be upon us, because of the oath which we sware unto them.* This we will do to them: let them live, lest wrath be upon us, because of the oath that we swore to them."
- 21 *And the princes said unto them, Let them live; but let them be hewers of wood and drawers of water unto all the congregation; as the princes had promised them.* the leaders said to them, "Let them live." So they became cutters of wood and drawers of water for all the congregation, just as the leaders had said of them.
- 22 *And Joshua called for them, and he spake unto them, saying, Wherefore have ye beguiled us, saying, We are very far from you; when ye dwell among us?* Joshua summoned them. He said to them, "Why did you deceive us, saying, 'We are very far from you,' when you dwell among us?"
- 23 *Now therefore ye are cursed, and there shall none of you be freed from being bondmen, and hewers of wood and drawers of water for the house of my God.* Now therefore you are cursed. Some of you shall never be anything but servants, cutters of wood and drawers of water for the house of my God."
- 24 *And they answered Joshua, and said, Because it was certainly told thy servants, how that the LORD thy God commanded his servant Moses to give you all the land, and to destroy all the inhabitants of the land from before you, therefore we were sore afraid of our lives because of you, and have done this thing.* They answered Joshua, "Because it was told to your servants for a certainty that the LORD your God had commanded His servant Moses to give you all the land and to destroy all the inhabitants of the land from before You—so we feared greatly for our lives because of You and did this thing.
- 25 *And now, behold, we are in thine hand: as it seemeth good and right unto thee to do unto us, do.* now, we are in Your hand. Whatever seems good and right in Your sight to do to us, do it."
- 26 *And so did he unto them, and delivered them out of the hand of the children of Israel, that they slew them not.* So He did this to them and delivered them out of the hand of the people of Israel. They did not kill them.

- 27 *And Joshua made them that day hewers of wood and drawers of water for the congregation, and for the altar of the LORD, even unto this day, in the place which he should choose.* But Joshua made them that day cutters of wood and drawers of water for the congregation and for the altar of the LORD, to this day, in the place that He should choose.

Words in this chapter:

Bashan (BAY-shan) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Gibeon (GIB-ee-on) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

v1 — Num 34:6

v3 — Josh 10:2

v6 — Josh 5:10

v7 — Josh 11:19

v9 — Deut 20:15

v14 — Prov 3:5-6; Num 27:21; 1 Chr 10:13-14; 2 Sam 5:19; 1 Sam 23:9-12

v15 — 2 Sam 21:2

v21 — Deut 29:11

v23 — Josh 9:21

Chapter 10

Five Amorite kings attacked Gibeon, and Joshua marched all night from Gilgal to rescue them; the LORD threw the enemy into confusion, cast great hailstones, and the sun stood still until Israel had avenged themselves. Joshua then conquered the southern cities of Makkedah, Libnah, Lachish, Eglon, Hebron, and Debir.

- 1 *Now it came to pass, when Adonizedek king of Jerusalem had heard how Joshua had taken Ai, and had utterly destroyed it; as he had done to Jericho and her king, so he had done to Ai and her king; and how the inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace with Israel, and were among them;* As soon as Adoni-zedek, king of Jerusalem, heard how Joshua had captured Ai and had devoted it to destruction, doing to Ai and its king as he had done to Jericho and its king, and how the inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace with Israel and were among them,

- 2 *That they feared greatly, because Gibeon was a great city, as one of the royal cities, and because it was greater than Ai, and all the men thereof were mighty.* he feared greatly, because Gibeon was a great city, like one of the royal cities, and because it was greater than Ai. All its men were warriors.
- 3 *Wherefore Adonizedek king of Jerusalem sent unto Hoham king of Hebron, and unto Piram king of Jarmuth, and unto Japhia king of Lachish, and unto Debir king of Eglon, saying,* So Adoni-zedek king of Jerusalem sent to Hoham king of Hebron, to Piram king of Jarmuth, to Japhia king of Lachish, and to Debir king of Eglon, saying,
- 4 *Come up unto me, and help me, that we may smite Gibeon: for it hath made peace with Joshua and with the children of Israel.* "Come up to me and help me, and let us strike Gibeon. For it has made peace with Joshua and with the people of Israel."
- 5 *Therefore the five kings of the Amorites, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, the king of Eglon, gathered themselves together, and went up, they and all their hosts, and encamped before Gibeon, and made war against it.* Then the five kings of the Amorites, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon, gathered their forces and went up with all their armies and encamped against Gibeon and made war against it.
- 6 *And the men of Gibeon sent unto Joshua to the camp to Gilgal, saying, Slack not thy hand from thy servants; come up to us quickly, and save us, and help us: for all the kings of the Amorites that dwell in the mountains are gathered together against us.* the men of Gibeon sent to Joshua at the camp in Gilgal, saying, "Do not relax your hand from your servants. Come up to us quickly and save us and help us, for all the kings of the Amorites who dwell in the hill country are gathered against us."
- 7 *So Joshua ascended from Gilgal, he, and all the people of war with him, and all the mighty men of valour.* So Joshua went up from Gilgal, he and all the people of war with him. All the mighty men of valor.

- 8 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Fear them not: for I have delivered them into thine hand; there shall not a man of them stand before thee.* the LORD said to Joshua, "Do not fear them, for I have given them into your hands. Not a man of them shall stand before you."
- 9 *Joshua therefore came unto them suddenly, and went up from Gilgal all night.* So Joshua came upon them suddenly, having marched up all night from Gilgal.
- 10 *And the LORD discomfited them before Israel, and slew them with a great slaughter at Gibeon, and chased them along the way that goeth up to Bethhoron, and smote them to Azekah, and unto Makkedah.* the LORD threw them into a panic before Israel, who struck them with a great blow at Gibeon and chased them by the way of the ascent of Beth-horon and struck them as far as Azekah and Makkedah.
- 11 *And it came to pass, as they fled from before Israel, and were in the going down to Bethhoron, that the LORD cast down great stones from heaven upon them unto Azekah, and they died: they were more which died with hailstones than they whom the children of Israel slew with the sword.* as they fled before Israel, while they were going down the ascent of Beth-horon, the LORD threw down large stones from heaven on them as far as Azekah. They died. There were more who died because of the hailstones than the sons of Israel killed with the sword.
- 12 *Then spake Joshua to the LORD in the day when the LORD delivered up the Amorites before the children of Israel, and he said in the sight of Israel, Sun, stand thou still upon Gibeon; and thou, Moon, in the valley of Ajalon.* At that time Joshua spoke to the LORD in the day when the LORD gave the Amorites over to the sons of Israel. He said in the sight of Israel, "Sun, stand still at Gibeon, and moon, in the Valley of Aijalon."
- 13 *And the sun stood still, and the moon stayed, until the people had avenged themselves upon their enemies. Is not this written in the book of Jasher? So the sun stood still in the midst of heaven, and hasted not to go down about a whole day.* the sun stood still, and the moon stopped, until the nation took vengeance on their enemies. Is this not written in the book of Jasher? The sun stopped in the midst of heaven and did not hurry to set for about a whole day.

- 14 *And there was no day like that before it or after it, that the LORD hearkened unto the voice of a man: for the LORD fought for Israel.* There has been no day like it before or since, when the LORD heeded the voice of a man, for the LORD fought for Israel.
- 15 *And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, unto the camp to Gilgal.* Then Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to the camp at Gilgal.
- 16 *But these five kings fled, and hid themselves in a cave at Makkedah.* These five kings fled and hid themselves in the cave at Makkedah.
- 17 *And it was told Joshua, saying, The five kings are found hid in a cave at Makkedah.* it was told to Joshua, "The five kings have been found, hidden in the cave at Makkedah."
- 18 *And Joshua said, Roll great stones upon the mouth of the cave, and set men by it for to keep them:* Joshua said, "Roll large stones against the mouth of the cave and set men by it to guard them,
- 19 *And stay ye not, but pursue after your enemies, and smite the hindmost of them; suffer them not to enter into their cities: for the LORD your God hath delivered them into your hand.* but do not stay there yourselves. Pursue Your enemies; attack their rear guard. Do not let them enter their cities, for the LORD Your God has given them into Your hand."
- 20 *And it came to pass, when Joshua and the children of Israel had made an end of slaying them with a very great slaughter, till they were consumed, that the rest which remained of them entered into fenced cities.* When Joshua and the sons of Israel had finished striking them with a very great blow, until they were wiped out, and when the remnant that remained of them had entered into the fortified cities,
- 21 *And all the people returned to the camp to Joshua at Makkedah in peace: none moved his tongue against any of the children of Israel.* all the people returned safe to Joshua in the camp at Makkedah. Not a man moved his tongue against any of the people of Israel.
- 22 *Then said Joshua, Open the mouth of the cave, and bring out those five kings unto me out of the cave.* Then Joshua said, "Open the mouth of the cave and bring those five kings out to me from the cave."

- 23 *And they did so, and brought forth those five kings unto him out of the cave, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon.* they did so, and brought those five kings out to him from the cave, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon.
- 24 *And it came to pass, when they brought out those kings unto Joshua, that Joshua called for all the men of Israel, and said unto the captains of the men of war which went with him, Come near, put your feet upon the necks of these kings. And they came near, and put their feet upon the necks of them.* when they brought those kings out to Joshua, Joshua summoned all the men of Israel and said to the chiefs of the men of war who had gone with him, "Come near; put your feet on the necks of these kings." Then they came near and put their feet on their necks.
- 25 *And Joshua said unto them, Fear not, nor be dismayed, be strong and of good courage: for thus shall the LORD do to all your enemies against whom ye fight.* Joshua said to them, "Do not be afraid or dismayed; be strong and courageous. For thus the LORD will do to all Your enemies against whom You fight."
- 26 *And afterward Joshua smote them, and slew them, and hanged them on five trees: and they were hanging upon the trees until the evening.* afterward Joshua struck them and put them to death. He hanged them on five trees. And they hung on the trees until evening.
- 27 *And it came to pass at the time of the going down of the sun, that Joshua commanded, and they took them down off the trees, and cast them into the cave wherein they had been hid, and laid great stones in the cave's mouth, which remain until this very day.* But at the time of the going down of the sun, Joshua commanded. They took them down from the trees and threw them into the cave where they had hidden themselves. They set large stones against the mouth of the cave, which remain to this very day.

- 28 *And that day Joshua took Makkedah, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and the king thereof he utterly destroyed, them, and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain: and he did to the king of Makkedah as he did unto the king of Jericho.* As for Makkedah, Joshua captured it on that day and struck it, and its king, with the edge of the sword. He devoted to destruction every person in it; he left none remaining. And he did to the king of Makkedah just as he had done to the king of Jericho.
- 29 *Then Joshua passed from Makkedah, and all Israel with him, unto Libnah, and fought against Libnah:* Then Joshua and all Israel with him passed on from Makkedah to Libnah and fought against Libnah.
- 30 *And the LORD delivered it also, and the king thereof, into the hand of Israel; and he smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain in it; but did unto the king thereof as he did unto the king of Jericho.* the LORD gave it also and its king into the hand of Israel. And He struck it with the edge of the sword, and every person in it; he left none remaining in it. And He did to its king as He had done to the king of Jericho.
- 31 *And Joshua passed from Libnah, and all Israel with him, unto Lachish, and encamped against it, and fought against it:* Then Joshua and all Israel with him passed on from Libnah to Lachish and laid siege to it and fought against it.
- 32 *And the LORD delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel, which took it on the second day, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein, according to all that he had done to Libnah.* the LORD gave Lachish into the hand of Israel. He captured it on the second day and struck it with the edge of the sword, and every person in it, according to all that he had done to Libnah.
- 33 *Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish; and Joshua smote him and his people, until he had left him none remaining.* Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish. And Joshua struck him and his people, until he left none remaining.
- 34 *And from Lachish Joshua passed unto Eglon, and all Israel with him; and they encamped against it, and fought against it:* Then Joshua and all Israel with him passed on from Lachish to Eglon. And they laid siege to it and fought against it.

- 35 *And they took it on that day, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein he utterly destroyed that day, according to all that he had done to Lachish.* they captured it on that day, and struck it with the edge of the sword. And every person in it he devoted to destruction that day, according to all that he had done to Lachish.
- 36 *And Joshua went up from Eglon, and all Israel with him, unto Hebron; and they fought against it:* Then Joshua and all Israel with him went up from Eglon to Hebron. And they fought against it
- 37 *And they took it, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and the king thereof, and all the cities thereof, and all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining, according to all that he had done to Eglon; but destroyed it utterly, and all the souls that were therein.* captured it and struck it with the edge of the sword, and its king and its towns, and every person in it. He left none remaining, according to all that he had done to Eglon, and devoted it to destruction and every person in it.
- 38 *And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to Debir; and fought against it:* Then Joshua and all Israel with him turned back to Debir and fought against it
- 39 *And he took it, and the king thereof, and all the cities thereof; and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining: as he had done to Hebron, so he did to Debir, and to the king thereof; as he had done also to Libnah, and to her king.* he captured it with its king and all its towns. And they struck them with the edge of the sword and devoted to destruction every person in it; he left none remaining. Just as he had done to Hebron and to Libnah and its king, so he did to Debir and to its king.
- 40 *So Joshua smote all the country of the hills, and of the south, and of the vale, and of the springs, and all their kings: he left none remaining, but utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD God of Israel commanded.* So Joshua struck the whole land, the hill country and the south and the lowland and the slopes, and all their kings. He left none remaining, but devoted to destruction all that breathed, just as the LORD God of Israel commanded.

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| <p>41 <i>And Joshua smote them from Kadeshbarnea even unto Gaza, and all the country of Goshen, even unto Gibeon.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And all these kings and their land did Joshua take at one time, because the LORD God of Israel fought for Israel.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, unto the camp to Gilgal.</i></p> | <p>Joshua struck them from Kadesh-barnea as far as Gaza, and all the country of Goshen, as far as Gibeon.</p> <p>Joshua captured all these kings and their land at one time, because the LORD God of Israel fought for Israel.</p> <p>Then Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to the camp at Gilgal.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Goshen (*GO-shen*) — The region of Egypt where the Israelites settled at Joseph's invitation — a fertile land in the eastern Nile delta; they remained there during the plagues while Egypt suffered.

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 11:25
- v4 — Josh 9:15
- v8 — Rom 8:31; Deut 3:2; Ps 27:1-2; Isa 41:10-15; Josh 11:6
- v10 — Ps 18:14
- v11 — Isa 28:2
- v12 — Hab 3:11; Isa 38:8; Isa 60:20; Deut 4:19; Isa 28:21
- v13 — Hab 3:11; Isa 38:8; Josh 10:14; Judg 16:28; 2 Sam 1:18
- v14 — Deut 1:30; Ex 14:14; Josh 10:42; Josh 23:3; Luke 17:6
- v21 — Ex 11:7
- v24 — Rev 2:26-27; Rom 16:20; Mal 4:3; Ps 110:1; Ps 107:40
- v25 — Josh 1:9; 2 Cor 1:10; Eph 6:10; 1 Sam 17:37; Rom 8:37
- v33 — Judg 1:29; Josh 16:10

Chapter 11

Jabin king of Hazor assembled a vast northern coalition against Israel at the waters of Merom, but the LORD gave them into Joshua's hand. Joshua burned Hazor, hamstringing the horses, destroyed the Anakim, and took the whole land as the LORD had commanded Moses.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when Jabin king of Hazor had heard those things, that he sent to Jobab king of Madon, and to the king of Shimron, and to the king of Achshaph,* When Jabin, king of Hazor, heard of this, he sent to Jobab king of Madon, and to the king of Shimron, and to the king of Achshaph,
- 2 *And to the kings that were on the north of the mountains, and of the plains south of Chinneroth, and in the valley, and in the borders of Dor on the west,* to the kings who were in the northern hill country, and in the Arabah south of Chinneroth, and in the lowland, and in Naphoth-dor on the west,
- 3 *And to the Canaanite on the east and on the west, and to the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, and the Jebusite in the mountains, and to the Hivite under Hermon in the land of Mizpeh.* to the Canaanites in the east and the west, the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, and the Jebusites in the hill country, and the Hivites under Hermon in the land of Mizpah.
- 4 *And they went out, they and all their hosts with them, much people, even as the sand that is upon the sea shore in multitude, with horses and chariots very many.* they came out with all their troops, a great horde, in number like the sand that is on the seashore, with very many horses and chariots.
- 5 *And when all these kings were met together, they came and pitched together at the waters of Merom, to fight against Israel.* all these kings joined their forces and came and encamped together at the waters of Merom to fight against Israel.
- 6 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Be not afraid because of them: for to morrow about this time will I deliver them up all slain before Israel: thou shalt hough their horses, and burn their chariots with fire.* the LORD said to Joshua, "Do not be afraid of them, for tomorrow at this time I will give over all of them, slain, to Israel. You shall hamstring their horses and burn their chariots with fire."
- 7 *So Joshua came, and all the people of war with him, against them by the waters of Merom suddenly; and they fell upon them.* So Joshua and all his warriors came suddenly against them by the waters of Merom and fell upon them.

- 8 *And the LORD delivered them into the hand of Israel, who smote them, and chased them unto great Zidon, and unto Misrephothmaim, and unto the valley of Mizpeh eastward; and they smote them, until they left them none remaining.* the LORD gave them into the hand of Israel, who struck them and chased them as far as great Zidon and Misrephoth-maim, and eastward as far as the Valley of Mizpeh. And they struck them until He left none remaining.
- 9 *And Joshua did unto them as the LORD bade him: he houghed their horses, and burnt their chariots with fire.* Joshua did to them just as the LORD said to Him: He hamstrung their horses and burned their chariots with fire.
- 10 *And Joshua at that time turned back, and took Hazor, and smote the king thereof with the sword: for Hazor beforetime was the head of all those kingdoms.* Joshua turned back at that time and captured Hazor and struck its king with the sword, for Hazor formerly was the head of all those kingdoms.
- 11 *And they smote all the souls that were therein with the edge of the sword, utterly destroying them: there was not any left to breathe: and he burnt Hazor with fire.* they struck with the sword all who were in it, devoting them to destruction; there was none left that breathed. And he burned Hazor with fire.
- 12 *And all the cities of those kings, and all the kings of them, did Joshua take, and smote them with the edge of the sword, and he utterly destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the LORD commanded.* all the cities of those kings, and all their kings, Joshua captured, and struck them with the edge of the sword, devoting them to destruction, just as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded.
- 13 *But as for the cities that stood still in their strength, Israel burned none of them, save Hazor only; that did Joshua burn.* But none of the cities that stood on mounds did Israel burn, except Hazor alone; that Joshua burned.

- 14 *And all the spoil of these cities, and the cattle, the children of Israel took for a prey unto themselves; but every man they smote with the edge of the sword, until they had destroyed them, neither left they any to breathe.* all the spoil of these cities and the livestock, the people of Israel took for their plunder. But every person they struck with the edge of the sword until they had destroyed them. They did not leave any who breathed.
- 15 *As the LORD commanded Moses his servant, so did Moses command Joshua, and so did Joshua; he left nothing undone of all that the LORD commanded Moses.* Just as the LORD had commanded Moses his servant, so Moses commanded Joshua, and so Joshua did. He left nothing undone of all that the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 16 *So Joshua took all that land, the hills, and all the south country, and all the land of Goshen, and the valley, and the plain, and the mountain of Israel, and the valley of the same;* So Joshua took all that land, the hill country and all the south country and all the land of Goshen and the lowland and the Arabah and the hill country of Israel and its lowland
- 17 *Even from the mount Halak, that goeth up to Seir, even unto Baalgad in the valley of Lebanon under mount Hermon: and all their kings he took, and smote them, and slew them.* from Mount Halak, which rises toward Seir, as far as Baal-gad in the Valley of Lebanon below Mount Hermon. And he captured all their kings and struck them and put them to death.
- 18 *Joshua made war a long time with all those kings.* Joshua made war a long time with all those kings.
- 19 *There was not a city that made peace with the children of Israel, save the Hivites the inhabitants of Gibeon: all other they took in battle.* There was not a city that made peace with the people of Israel except the Hivites, the inhabitants of Gibeon. They took all in battle.
- 20 *For it was of the LORD to harden their hearts, that they should come against Israel in battle, that he might destroy them utterly, and that they might have no favour, but that he might destroy them, as the LORD commanded Moses.* For it was the LORD's doing to harden their hearts that they should come against Israel in battle, in order that they should be devoted to destruction and should receive no mercy but be destroyed, just as the LORD commanded Moses.

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| <p>21 <i>And at that time came Joshua, and cut off the Anakims from the mountains, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, and from all the mountains of Judah, and from all the mountains of Israel: Joshua destroyed them utterly with their cities.</i></p> <p>22 <i>There was none of the Anakims left in the land of the children of Israel: only in Gaza, in Gath, and in Ashdod, there remained.</i></p> <p>23 <i>So Joshua took the whole land, according to all that the LORD said unto Moses; and Joshua gave it for an inheritance unto Israel according to their divisions by their tribes. And the land rested from war.</i></p> | <p>Joshua came at that time and cut off the Anakim from the hill country, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, and from all the hill country of Judah, and from all the hill country of Israel. Joshua devoted them to destruction with their cities.</p> <p>There was none of the Anakim left in the land of the people of Israel. Only in Gaza, in Gath, and in Ashdod did some remain.</p> <p>So Joshua took the whole land, according to all that the LORD had spoken to Moses. And Joshua gave it for an inheritance to Israel according to their tribal allotments. And the land had rest from war.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Josh 12:3; Judg 1:27
 v3 — Judg 3:3
 v4 — Judg 7:12
 v6 — Josh 10:8; 2 Sam 8:4
 v8 — Josh 13:6
 v12 — Deut 20:16-17; Deut 7:2
 v15 — Josh 1:7; Ex 34:11-13; Deut 7:2; Acts 20:20
 v16 — Josh 10:41
 v17 — Deut 7:24
 v20 — Rom 9:18; Deut 20:16-17; Ex 4:21
 v22 — 1 Sam 17:4
 v23 — Josh 21:44-45; Num 26:52-55

Chapter 12

The kings defeated by Moses east of the Jordan—Sihon and Og—are listed, along with thirty-one kings defeated by Joshua west of the Jordan.

- 1 *Now these are the kings of the land, which the children of Israel smote, and possessed their land on the other side Jordan toward the rising of the sun, from the river Arnon unto mount Hermon, and all the plain on the east:* Now these are the kings of the land whom the people of Israel defeated and whose land they took possession of beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise, from the Valley of the Arnon to Mount Hermon, with all the Arabah to the east:
- 2 *Sihon king of the Amorites, who dwelt in Heshbon, and ruled from Aroer, which is upon the bank of the river Arnon, and from the middle of the river, and from half Gilead, even unto the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon;* Sihon king of the Amorites who lived at Heshbon and ruled from Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, and from the middle of the valley as far as the river Jabbok, the boundary of the Ammonites, that is, half of Gilead,
- 3 *And from the plain to the sea of Chinneroth on the east, and unto the sea of the plain, even the salt sea on the east, the way to Bethjesimoth; and from the south, under Ashdothpishgah:* the Arabah to the Sea of Chinneroth eastward, and in the direction of Beth-jeshimoth, to the Sea of the Arabah, the Salt Sea, southward to the foot of the slopes of Pisgah;

- 4 *And the coast of Og king of Bashan, which was of the remnant of the giants, that dwelt at Astaroth and at Edrei,* Og king of Bashan, one of the remnant of the giants, who lived at Ashtaroth and at Edrei
- 5 *And reigned in mount Hermon, and in Salcah, and in all Bashan, unto the border of the Geshurites and the Maachathites, and half Gilead, the border of Sihon king of Heshbon.* ruled over Mount Hermon and Salecah and all Bashan to the boundary of the Geshurites and the Maachathites, and over half of Gilead to the boundary of Sihon king of Heshbon.
- 6 *Them did Moses the servant of the LORD and the children of Israel smite: and Moses the servant of the LORD gave it for a possession unto the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh.* Moses, the servant of the LORD, and the people of Israel defeated them. And Moses the servant of the LORD gave their land as a possession to the Reubenites and the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 7 *And these are the kings of the country which Joshua and the children of Israel smote on this side Jordan on the west, from Baalgad in the valley of Lebanon even unto the mount Halak, that goeth up to Seir; which Joshua gave unto the tribes of Israel for a possession according to their divisions;* these are the kings of the land whom Joshua and the people of Israel defeated on the west side of the Jordan, from Baal-gad in the Valley of Lebanon to Mount Halak, that rises toward Seir (and Joshua gave their land to the tribes of Israel as a possession according to their allotments,
- 8 *In the mountains, and in the valleys, and in the plains, and in the springs, and in the wilderness, and in the south country; the Hittites, the Amorites, and the Canaanites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites:* in the hill country, in the lowland, in the Arabah, on the slopes, in the wilderness, and in the south country, the land of the Hittites, the Amorites, the Canaanites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites):
- 9 *The king of Jericho, one; the king of Ai, which is beside Bethel, one;* the king of Jericho, one; the king of Ai, which is beside Bethel, one;
- 10 *The king of Jerusalem, one; the king of Hebron, one;* the king of Jerusalem, one; the king of Hebron, one;

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| 11 <i>The king of Jarmuth, one; the king of Lachish, one;</i> | the king of Jarmuth, one; the king of Lachish, one; |
| 12 <i>The king of Eglon, one; the king of Gezer, one;</i> | the king of Eglon, one; the king of Gezer, one; |
| 13 <i>The king of Debir, one; the king of Geder, one;</i> | the king of Debir, one; the king of Geder, one; |
| 14 <i>The king of Hormah, one; the king of Arad, one;</i> | the king of Hormah, one; the king of Arad, one; |
| 15 <i>The king of Libnah, one; the king of Adullam, one;</i> | the king of Libnah, one; the king of Adullam, one; |
| 16 <i>The king of Makkedah, one; the king of Bethel, one;</i> | the king of Makkedah, one; the king of Bethel, one; |
| 17 <i>The king of Tappuah, one; the king of Hephher, one;</i> | the king of Tappuah, one; the king of Hephher, one; |
| 18 <i>The king of Aphek, one; the king of Lasharon, one;</i> | the king of Aphek, one; the king of Lasharon, one; |
| 19 <i>The king of Madon, one; the king of Hazor, one;</i> | the king of Madon, one; the king of Hazor, one; |
| 20 <i>The king of Shimronmeron, one; the king of Achshaph, one;</i> | the king of Shimron-meron, one; the king of Achshaph, one; |
| 21 <i>The king of Taanach, one; the king of Megiddo, one;</i> | the king of Taanach, one; the king of Megiddo, one; |
| 22 <i>The king of Kedesh, one; the king of Jokneam of Carmel, one;</i> | the king of Kedesh, one; the king of Jokneam in Carmel, one; |
| 23 <i>The king of Dor in the coast of Dor, one; the king of the nations of Gilgal, one;</i> | the king of Dor in Naphath-dor, one; the king of the nations of Gilgal, one; |
| 24 <i>The king of Tirzah, one: all the kings thirty and one.</i> | the king of Tirzah, one: in all, thirty-one kings. |

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Megiddo (*meh-GID-oh*) — A strategic city at the pass through the Carmel range — site of many decisive battles; in Revelation, Armageddon (Har-Megiddo) is the great final battlefield.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 3:8-9
- v3 — Deut 3:17; Josh 11:2; Josh 13:20
- v4 — Deut 1:4
- v5 — Deut 3:14
- v7 — Josh 11:17
- v8 — Josh 11:16
- v10 — Josh 10:23
- v12 — Josh 10:33
- v19 — Josh 11:1
- v20 — Josh 11:1

Chapter 13

God told the aging Joshua that much land remained to be possessed and commanded him to divide it among the nine and a half tribes. The territories of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh east of the Jordan are described, and the tribe of Levi received no land inheritance.

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| 1 | <i>Now Joshua was old and stricken in years; and the LORD said unto him, Thou art old and stricken in years, and there remaineth yet very much land to be possessed.</i> | Now Joshua was old and advanced in years. The LORD said to Him, "You are old and advanced in years, and there remains yet very much land to possess. |
| 2 | <i>This is the land that yet remaineth: all the borders of the Philistines, and all Geshuri,</i> | This is the land that yet remains: all the borders of the Philistines, and all Geshuri |

- 3 *From Sihor, which is before Egypt, even unto the borders of Ekron northward, which is counted to the Canaanite: five lords of the Philistines; the Gazathites, and the Ashdothites, the Eshkalonites, the Gittites, and the Ekronites; also the Avites:* (from Sihor, which is east of Egypt, northward to the boundary of Ekron, it is counted as Canaanite; there are five rulers of the Philistines, those of Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Gath, and Ekron), and those of the Avites,
- 4 *From the south, all the land of the Canaanites, and Mearah that is beside the Sidonians, unto Aphek, to the borders of the Amorites:* in the south, all the land of the Canaanites, and Mearah that belongs to the Sidonians, to Aphek, to the boundary of the Amorites,
- 5 *And the land of the Giblites, and all Lebanon, toward the sunrising, from Baalgad under mount Hermon unto the entering into Hamath.* the land of the Giblites, and all Lebanon, toward the sunrise, from Baal-gad below Mount Hermon to the entering into Hamath,
- 6 *All the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon unto Misrephothmaim, and all the Sidonians, them will I drive out from before the children of Israel: only divide thou it by lot unto the Israelites for an inheritance, as I have commanded thee.* all the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon to Misrephoth-maim, even all the Sidonians. I myself will drive them out from before the people of Israel. Only allot the land to Israel for an inheritance, as I have commanded You.
- 7 *Now therefore divide this land for an inheritance unto the nine tribes, and the half tribe of Manasseh,* Now therefore divide this land for an inheritance to the nine tribes and half the tribe of Manasseh."
- 8 *With whom the Reubenites and the Gadites have received their inheritance, which Moses gave them, beyond Jordan eastward, even as Moses the servant of the LORD gave them;* With the other half of the tribe of Manasseh the Reubenites and the Gadites received their inheritance, which Moses gave them, beyond the Jordan eastward, as Moses the servant of the LORD gave them:

- 9 *From Aroer, that is upon the bank of the river Arnon, and the city that is in the midst of the river, and all the plain of Medeba unto Dibon;* from Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain of Medeba as far as Dibon;
- 10 *And all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites, which reigned in Heshbon, unto the border of the children of Ammon;* all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, as far as the boundary of the Ammonites;
- 11 *And Gilead, and the border of the Geshurites and Maachathites, and all mount Hermon, and all Bashan unto Salcah;* Gilead, and the region of the Geshurites and Maachathites, and all mount Hermon, and all Bashan unto Salcah;
- 12 *All the kingdom of Og in Bashan, which reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei, who remained of the remnant of the giants: for these did Moses smite, and cast them out.* all the kingdom of Og in Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei (he alone was left of the remnant of the giants); these Moses had defeated and driven out.
- 13 *Nevertheless the children of Israel expelled not the Geshurites, nor the Maachathites: but the Geshurites and the Maachathites dwell among the Israelites until this day.* Yet the people of Israel did not drive out the Geshurites or the Maachathites, but Geshur and Maacath dwell in the midst of Israel to this day.
- 14 *Only unto the tribe of Levi he gave none inheritance; the sacrifices of the LORD God of Israel made by fire are their inheritance, as he said unto them.* To the tribe of Levi alone Moses gave no inheritance. The offerings made by fire to the LORD God of Israel are their inheritance, as He said to them.
- 15 *And Moses gave unto the tribe of the children of Reuben inheritance according to their families.* Moses gave an inheritance to the tribe of the people of Reuben according to their clans.
- 16 *And their coast was from Aroer, that is on the bank of the river Arnon, and the city that is in the midst of the river, and all the plain by Medeba;* Their territory was from Aroer, which is on the edge of the Valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain by Medeba;

- 17 *Heshbon, and all her cities that are in the plain; Dibon, and Bamothbaal, and Bethbaalmeon,* Heshbon, and all her cities that are in the plain; Dibon, and Bamoth-baal, and Beth-baal-meon,
- 18 *And Jahazah, and Kedemoth, and Mephaath,* Jahaz, and Kedemoth, and Mephaath,
- 19 *And Kirjathaim, and Sibmah, and Zarethshahar in the mount of the valley,* Kiriathaim, and Sibmah, and Zereeth-shahar on the hill of the valley,
- 20 *And Bethpeor, and Ashdothpishgah, and Bethjeshimoth,* Beth-peor, and the slopes of Pishgah, and Beth-jeshimoth,
- 21 *And all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, which reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses smote with the princes of Midian, Evi, and Rekem, and Zur, and Hur, and Reba, which were dukes of Sihon, dwelling in the country.* that is, all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses defeated with the leaders of Midian, Evi and Rekem and Zur and Hur and Reba, the princes of Sihon, who lived in the land.
- 22 *Balaam also the son of Beor, the soothsayer, did the children of Israel slay with the sword among them that were slain by them.* Balaam also, the son of Beor, the one who practiced divination, was killed with the sword by the people of Israel among the rest of their slain.
- 23 *And the border of the children of Reuben was Jordan, and the border thereof. This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben after their families, the cities and the villages thereof.* the boundary of the people of Reuben was the Jordan as a boundary. This was the inheritance of the people of Reuben, according to their clans with their cities and villages.
- 24 *And Moses gave inheritance unto the tribe of Gad, even unto the children of Gad according to their families.* Moses gave an inheritance to the tribe of Gad, to the people of Gad, according to their clans.
- 25 *And their coast was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the children of Ammon, unto Aroer that is before Rabbah;* Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the Ammonites, to Aroer, which is east of Rabbah,

- 26 *And from Heshbon unto Ramathmizpeh, and Betonim; and from Mahanaim unto the border of Debir;* from Heshbon to Ramath-mizpeh and Betonim, and from Mahanaim to the territory of Debir,
- 27 *And in the valley, Betharam, and Bethnimrah, and Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, Jordan and his border, even unto the edge of the sea of Chinnereth on the other side Jordan eastward.* in the valley Beth-haram, Beth-nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, with the Jordan as a boundary, to the lower end of the Sea of Chinnereth, eastward beyond the Jordan.
- 28 *This is the inheritance of the children of Gad after their families, the cities, and their villages.* This is the inheritance of the people of Gad according to their clans, with their cities and villages.
- 29 *And Moses gave inheritance unto the half tribe of Manasseh: and this was the possession of the half tribe of the children of Manasseh by their families.* Moses gave an inheritance to the half-tribe of Manasseh. It was allotted to the half-tribe of the people of Manasseh according to their clans.
- 30 *And their coast was from Mahanaim, all Bashan, all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the towns of Jair, which are in Bashan, threescore cities:* Their territory extended from Mahanaim, through all Bashan, the whole kingdom of Og king of Bashan. All the towns of Jair, which are in Bashan, sixty cities,
- 31 *And half Gilead, and Ashtaroth, and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan, were pertaining unto the children of Machir the son of Manasseh, even to the one half of the children of Machir by their families.* half of Gilead, and Ashtaroth, and Edrei, the cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan. These were allotted to the people of Machir the son of Manasseh for the half of the people of Machir according to their clans.
- 32 *These are the countries which Moses did distribute for inheritance in the plains of Moab, on the other side Jordan, by Jericho, eastward.* These are the inheritances that Moses distributed in the plains of Moab, beyond the Jordan east of Jericho.

- 33
- But unto the tribe of Levi, Moses gave not any inheritance: the LORD God of Israel was their inheritance, as he said unto them.*

But to the tribe of Levi Moses gave no inheritance; the LORD God of Israel is their inheritance, just as He said to them.

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen-z*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 14:10; Deut 31:3; Josh 24:29
- v5 — Josh 12:7; 1 Kgs 5:18
- v6 — Josh 11:8
- v14 — Num 18:20-24
- v16 — Josh 13:9
- v18 — Num 21:23
- v21 — Num 31:8
- v22 — Num 31:8; 2 Pet 2:15; Jude 1:11; Rev 2:14
- v33 — Josh 18:7; Josh 13:14; Deut 10:9; Deut 18:1-2

Chapter 14

The land of Canaan was distributed by lot at Gilgal under the oversight of Eleazar and Joshua. Caleb, now eighty-five years old and still strong, claimed Hebron as his inheritance because he had wholly followed the LORD.

- 1
- And these are the countries which the children of Israel inherited in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel, distributed for inheritance to them.*

These are the inheritances that the people of Israel received in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest and Joshua the son of Nun and the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the people of Israel gave them to inherit.

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| <p>2 <i>By lot was their inheritance, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses, for the nine tribes, and for the half tribe.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For Moses had given the inheritance of two tribes and an half tribe on the other side Jordan: but unto the Levites he gave none inheritance among them.</i></p> <p>4 <i>For the children of Joseph were two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim: therefore they gave no part unto the Levites in the land, save cities to dwell in, with their suburbs for their cattle and for their substance.</i></p> <p>5 <i>As the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel did, and they divided the land.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Then the children of Judah came unto Joshua in Gilgal: and Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite said unto him, Thou knowest the thing that the LORD said unto Moses the man of God concerning me and thee in Kadeshbarnea.</i></p> | <p>Their inheritance was by lot, just as the LORD had commanded through Moses, for the nine and a half tribes.</p> <p>For Moses had given an inheritance to the two and a half tribes beyond the Jordan, but to the Levites he gave no inheritance among them.</p> <p>For the people of Joseph were two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim. And no portion was given to the Levites in the land, but only cities to live in, with their pasturelands for their livestock and their substance.</p> <p>The people of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses; they allotted the land.</p> <p>Then the people of Judah came to Joshua at Gilgal. And Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite said to him, "You know what the LORD said to Moses the man of God in Kadesh-barnea concerning you and me.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Caleb** (KAY-leb) — "dog" (a term of loyalty) — Son of Jephunneh the Kenezite, one of only two spies (with Joshua) who brought a faithful report of Canaan. At 85 years old he claimed the hill country of Hebron and drove out the giants, saying "Give me this mountain" (14:12).

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| <p>7 <i>Forty years old was I when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadeshbarnea to espie out the land; and I brought him word again as it was in mine heart.</i></p> | <p>I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh-barnea to spy out the land. I brought Him word again as it was in my heart.</p> |
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- 8 *Nevertheless my brethren that went up with me made the heart of the people melt: but I wholly followed the LORD my God.* But my brothers who went up with me made the heart of the people melt; yet I wholly followed the LORD my God.
- 9 *And Moses sware on that day, saying, Surely the land whereon thy feet have trodden shall be thine inheritance, and thy children's for ever, because thou hast wholly followed the LORD my God.* Moses swore on that day, saying, 'Surely the land on which Your foot has trodden shall be an inheritance for You and Your children forever, because You have wholly followed the LORD my God.'
- 10 *And now, behold, the LORD hath kept me alive, as he said, these forty and five years, even since the LORD spake this word unto Moses, while the children of Israel wandered in the wilderness: and now, lo, I am this day fourscore and five years old.* now, the LORD has kept me alive, just as he said, these forty-five years since the time that the LORD spoke this word to Moses, while Israel walked in the wilderness. And now, I am this day eighty-five years old.
- 11 *As yet I am as strong this day as I was in the day that Moses sent me: as my strength was then, even so is my strength now, for war, both to go out, and to come in.* I am still as strong today as I was in the day that Moses sent me; my strength now is as my strength was then, for war and for going and coming.
- 12 *Now therefore give me this mountain, whereof the LORD spake in that day; for thou heardest in that day how the Anakims were there, and that the cities were great and fenced: if so be the LORD will be with me, then I shall be able to drive them out, as the LORD said.* So now give me this hill country of which the LORD spoke on that day, for You heard on that day how the Anakim were there, with great fortified cities. It may be that the LORD will be with me. I shall drive them out just as the LORD said."
- 13 *And Joshua blessed him, and gave unto Caleb the son of Jephunneh Hebron for an inheritance.* Then Joshua blessed him. He gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for an inheritance.

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| <p>14 <i>Hebron therefore became the inheritance of Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite unto this day, because that he wholly followed the LORD God of Israel.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the name of Hebron before was Kirjatharba; which Arba was a great man among the Anakims. And the land had rest from war.</i></p> | <p>Therefore Hebron became the inheritance of Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite to this day, because He wholly followed the LORD, the God of Israel.</p> <p>Now the name of Hebron formerly was Kiriath-arba. (Arba was the greatest man among the Anakim.) And the land had rest from war.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Num 34:13; Num 33:54

v4 — Gen 48:5

v6 — Num 14:30; Num 13:6; Num 14:24; Josh 14:14; Num 14:6

v8 — Num 14:24; Deut 1:36; Num 13:31

v9 — Josh 1:3; Deut 1:36

v11 — Deut 34:7; Ps 103:5

v12 — Heb 11:33; Phil 4:13; Num 13:33; Num 13:28; Rom 8:31

v13 — Judg 1:20; Josh 22:6

v15 — Josh 11:23; Gen 23:2

Chapter 15

The boundaries and cities of the territory allotted to the tribe of Judah are detailed, stretching from Edom in the south to the Mediterranean. Caleb drove out the Anakim from Hebron, and Othniel captured Kiriath-sepher to win Caleb's daughter Achsah; the Jebusites in Jerusalem could not be driven out.

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| <p>1 <i>This then was the lot of the tribe of the children of Judah by their families; even to the border of Edom the wilderness of Zin southward was the uttermost part of the south coast.</i></p> | <p>The allotment for the tribe of the people of Judah according to their clans reached southward to the boundary of Edom, to the wilderness of Zin at the farthest south.</p> |
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- 2 *And their south border was from the shore of the salt sea, from the bay that looketh southward:* their south boundary ran from the end of the Salt Sea, from the bay that faces southward.
- 3 *And it went out to the south side to Maalehakraabbim, and passed along to Zin, and ascended up on the south side unto Kadeshbarnea, and passed along to Hezron, and went up to Adar, and fetched a compass to Karkaa:* It goes out southward of the ascent of Akrabbim, passes along to Zin, and goes up south of Kadesh-barnea, along by Hezron, up to Addar, turns about to Karka,
- 4 *From thence it passed toward Azmon, and went out unto the river of Egypt; and the goings out of that coast were at the sea: this shall be your south coast.* passes along to Azmon, goes out by the Brook of Egypt, and comes to its end at the sea. This shall be your south boundary.
- 5 *And the east border was the salt sea, even unto the end of Jordan. And their border in the north quarter was from the bay of the sea at the uttermost part of Jordan:* the east boundary is the Salt Sea, to the mouth of the Jordan. And the boundary on the north side runs from the bay of the sea at the mouth of the Jordan.
- 6 *And the border went up to Bethhogla, and passed along by the north of Betharabah; and the border went up to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben:* the boundary goes up to Beth-hoglah and passes along north of Beth-arabah. And the boundary goes up to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben.
- 7 *And the border went up toward Debir from the valley of Achor, and so northward, looking toward Gilgal, that is before the going up to Adummim, which is on the south side of the river: and the border passed toward the waters of Enshemesh, and the goings out thereof were at Enrogel:* the boundary goes up to Debir from the Valley of Achor, and so northward, turning toward Gilgal, which is opposite the ascent of Adummim, which is on the south side of the valley. And the boundary passes along to the waters of En-shemesh and ends at En-rogel.

- 8 *And the border went up by the valley of the son of Hinnom unto the south side of the Jebusite; the same is Jerusalem: and the border went up to the top of the mountain that lieth before the valley of Hinnom westward, which is at the end of the valley of the giants northward:* Then the boundary goes up by the Valley of the Son of Hinnom at the southern shoulder of the Jebusite (that is, Jerusalem). And the boundary goes up to the top of the mountain that lies over against the Valley of Hinnom, on the west, at the northern end of the valley of the giants.
- 9 *And the border was drawn from the top of the hill unto the fountain of the water of Nephtoah, and went out to the cities of mount Ephron; and the border was drawn to Baalah, which is Kirjathjearim:* Then the boundary extends from the top of the mountain to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah, and from there to the cities of Mount Ephron. Then the boundary bends around to Baalah (that is, Kiriath-jearim).
- 10 *And the border compassed from Baalah westward unto mount Seir, and passed along unto the side of mount Jearim, which is Chesalon, on the north side, and went down to Bethshemesh, and passed on to Timnah:* the boundary circles west of Baalah to Mount Seir, passes along to the northern shoulder of Mount Jearim (that is, Chesalon), and goes down to Beth-shemesh and passes along by Timnah.
- 11 *And the border went out unto the side of Ekron northward: and the border was drawn to Shicron, and passed along to mount Baalah, and went out unto Jabneel; and the goings out of the border were at the sea.* The boundary goes out to the shoulder of the hill north of Ekron, then the boundary bends around to Shikkeron and passes along to Mount Baalah and goes out to Jabneel. Then the boundary comes to an end at the sea.
- 12 *And the west border was to the great sea, and the coast thereof. This is the coast of the children of Judah round about according to their families.* the west boundary was the Great Sea with its coastline. This is the boundary around the people of Judah according to their clans.

- 13 *And unto Caleb the son of Jephunneh he gave a part among the children of Judah, according to the commandment of the LORD to Joshua, even the city of Arba the father of Anak, which city is Hebron.* According to the commandment of the LORD to Joshua, he gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh a portion among the people of Judah, Kiriath-arba, that is, Hebron (Arba was the father of Anak).
- 14 *And Caleb drove thence the three sons of Anak, Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmi, the children of Anak.* Caleb drove out from there the three sons of Anak, Sheshai and Ahiman and Talmi, the descendants of Anak.
- 15 *And he went up thence to the inhabitants of Debir: and the name of Debir before was Kirjathsepher.* he went up from there against the inhabitants of Debir. Now the name of Debir formerly was Kiriath-sepher.
- 16 *And Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjathsepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.* Caleb said, "Whoever strikes Kiriath-sepher and captures it, to him I will give Achsah my daughter as wife."
- 17 *And Othniel the son of Kenaz, the brother of Caleb, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.* Othniel the son of Kenaz, the brother of Caleb, captured it. And he gave him Achsah his daughter as wife.
- 18 *And it came to pass, as she came unto him, that she moved him to ask of her father a field: and she lighted off her ass; and Caleb said unto her, What wouldest thou?* When she came to him, she urged him to ask her father for a field. And she got off her donkey, and Caleb said to her, "What do you want?"
- 19 *She answered, Give me a blessing; for thou hast given me a south land; give me also springs of water. And he gave her the upper springs, and the nether springs.* She said to him, "Give me a blessing. Since you have given me a south land, give me also springs of water." And he gave her the upper springs and the lower springs.
- 20 *This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families.* This is the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Judah according to their clans.

- 21 *And the uttermost cities of the tribe of the children of Judah toward the coast of Edom southward were Kabzeel, and Eder, and Jagur,* The cities belonging to the tribe of the people of Judah in the extreme south, toward the boundary of Edom, were Kabzeel, Eder, Jagur,
- 22 *And Kinah, and Dimonah, and Adadah,* Kinah, Dimonah, Adadah,
- 23 *And Kedesh, and Hazor, and Ithnan,* Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan,
- 24 *Ziph, and Telem, and Bealoth,* Ziph, Telem, Bealoth,
- 25 *And Hazor, Hadattah, and Keriath, and Hezron, which is Hazor,* Hazor-hadattah, Keriath-hezron (that is, Hazor),
- 26 *Amam, and Shema, and Moladah,* Amam, Shema, Moladah,
- 27 *And Hazargaddah, and Heshmon, and Bethpalet,* Hazar-gaddah, Heshmon, Beth-pelet,
- 28 *And Hazarshual, and Beersheba, and Bizjathjah,* Hazar-shual, Beersheba, Biziothiah,
- 29 *Baalath, and Iim, and Azem,* Baalah, Iim, Ezem,
- 30 *And Eltolad, and Chesil, and Hormah,* Eltolad, Chesil, Hormah,
- 31 *And Ziklag, and Madmannah, and Sansannah,* Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah,
- 32 *And Lebaoth, and Shilhim, and Ain, and Rimmon: all the cities are twenty and nine, with their villages:* Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, and Rimmon: in all, twenty-nine cities with their villages.
- 33 *And in the valley, Eshtaol, and Zoreah, and Ashnah,* in the lowland, Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah,
- 34 *And Zanoah, and Engannim, Tappuah, and Enam,* Zanoah, En-gannim, Tappuah, Enam,
- 35 *Jarmuth, and Adullam, Socoh, and Azekah,* Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah,
- 36 *And Sharaim, and Adithaim, and Gederah, and Gederothaim; fourteen cities with their villages:* Shaaraim, Adithaim, Gederah, Gederothaim: fourteen cities with their villages.

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| 37 | <i>Zenan, and Hadashah, and Migdalgad,</i> | Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal-gad, |
| 38 | <i>And Dilean, and Mizpeh, and Joktheel,</i> | Dilean, Mizpeh, Joktheel, |
| 39 | <i>Lachish, and Bozkath, and Eglon,</i> | Lachish, Bozkath, Eglon, |
| 40 | <i>And Cabbon, and Lahmam, and Kithlish,</i> | Cabbon, Lahmas, Chitlish, |
| 41 | <i>And Gederoth, Bethdagon, and Naamah, and Makkedah; sixteen cities with their villages:</i> | Gederoth, Beth-dagon, Naamah, and Makkedah: sixteen cities with their villages. |
| 42 | <i>Libnah, and Ether, and Ashan,</i> | Libnah, Ether, Ashan, |
| 43 | <i>And Jiphtah, and Ashnah, and Nezib,</i> | Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib, |
| 44 | <i>And Keilah, and Achzib, and Mareshah; nine cities with their villages:</i> | Keilah, Achzib, and Mareshah: nine cities with their villages. |
| 45 | <i>Ekron, with her towns and her villages:</i> | Ekron, with its towns and its villages; |
| 46 | <i>From Ekron even unto the sea, all that lay near Ashdod, with their villages:</i> | from Ekron to the sea, all that were by the side of Ashdod, with their villages. |
| 47 | <i>Ashdod with her towns and her villages, Gaza with her towns and her villages, unto the river of Egypt, and the great sea, and the border thereof:</i> | Ashdod, its towns and its villages; Gaza, its towns and its villages; to the Brook of Egypt, and the Great Sea with its coastline. |
| 48 | <i>And in the mountains, Shamir, and Jattir, and Socoh,</i> | in the hill country, Shamir, Jattir, Socoh, |
| 49 | <i>And Dannah, and Kirjathsannah, which is Debir,</i> | Dannah, Kiriath-sannah (that is, Debir), |
| 50 | <i>And Anab, and Eshtemoh, and Anim,</i> | Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim, |
| 51 | <i>And Goshen, and Holon, and Giloh; eleven cities with their villages:</i> | Goshen, Holon, and Giloh: eleven cities with their villages. |
| 52 | <i>Arab, and Dumah, and Eshean,</i> | Arab, Dumah, Eshan, |

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| 53 | <i>And Janum, and Bethtappuah, and Aphekah,</i> | Janim, Beth-tappuah, Aphekah, |
| 54 | <i>And Humtah, and Kirjatharba, which is Hebron, and Zior; nine cities with their villages:</i> | Humtah, Kiriath-arba (that is, Hebron), and Zior: nine cities with their villages. |
| 55 | <i>Maon, Carmel, and Ziph, and Juttah,</i> | Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Juttah, |
| 56 | <i>And Jezreel, and Jokdeam, and Zanoah,</i> | Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah, |
| 57 | <i>Cain, Gibeah, and Timnah; ten cities with their villages:</i> | Kain, Gibeah, and Timnah: ten cities with their villages. |
| 58 | <i>Halhul, Bethzur, and Gedor,</i> | Halhul, Beth-zur, Gedor, |
| 59 | <i>And Maarath, and Bethanoth, and Eltekon; six cities with their villages:</i> | Maarath, Beth-anoth, and Eltekon: six cities with their villages. |
| 60 | <i>Kirjathbaal, which is Kirjathjearim, and Rabbah; two cities with their villages:</i> | Kiriath-baal (that is, Kiriath-jearim), and Rabbah: two cities with their villages. |
| 61 | <i>In the wilderness, Betharabah, Middin, and Secacah,</i> | In the wilderness, Beth-arabah, Middin, Secacah, |
| 62 | <i>And Nibshan, and the city of Salt, and Engedi; six cities with their villages.</i> | Nibshan, the City of Salt, and En-gedi: six cities with their villages. |
| 63 | <i>As for the Jebusites the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the children of Judah could not drive them out: but the Jebusites dwell with the children of Judah at Jerusalem unto this day.</i> | But the Jebusites, the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the people of Judah could not drive out, so the Jebusites dwell with the people of Judah at Jerusalem to this day. |

Words in this chapter:

Cain (KAYN) — Adam and Eve's firstborn son — he killed his brother Abel and was sent away under God's curse to wander the earth.

Edom (EE-dom) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v3 — Num 34:4

- v4** — Num 34:5
v8 — Josh 18:16; Josh 15:63
v9 — 1 Chr 13:6
v10 — Judg 14:1
v19 — Judg 1:14-15
v21 — Gen 35:21
v31 — 1 Sam 27:6
v35 — 1 Sam 17:1; 1 Sam 22:1
v39 — Josh 10:3
v47 — Josh 15:4
v63 — Judg 1:21; Judg 1:8; 2 Sam 5:6-9

Chapter 16

The allotment for Ephraim is described, with boundaries from Ataroth-addar to the brook Kanah. The Canaanites in Gezer were not driven out but were put to forced labor.

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| <p>1 <i>And the lot of the children of Joseph fell from Jordan by Jericho, unto the water of Jericho on the east, to the wilderness that goeth up from Jericho throughout mount Bethel,</i></p> | <p>The allotment of the people of Joseph went from the Jordan by Jericho, east of the waters of Jericho, into the wilderness, going up from Jericho into the hill country to Bethel.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And goeth out from Bethel to Luz, and passeth along unto the borders of Archi to Ataroth,</i></p> | <p>Then going from Bethel to Luz, it passes along to Ataroth, the territory of the Archites.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And goeth down westward to the coast of Japhleti, unto the coast of Bethhoron the nether, and to Gezer: and the goings out thereof are at the sea.</i></p> | <p>Then it goes down westward to the territory of the Japhletites, as far as the territory of Lower Beth-horon, then to Gezer. It ends at the sea.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>So the children of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, took their inheritance.</i></p> | <p>The people of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, received their inheritance.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the border of the children of Ephraim according to their families was thus: even the border of their inheritance on the east side was Atarothaddar, unto Bethhoron the upper;</i></p> | <p>The territory of the people of Ephraim by their clans was as follows: the boundary of their inheritance on the east was Ataroth-addar as far as Upper Beth-horon,</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And the border went out toward the sea to Michmethah on the north side; and the border went about eastward unto Taanathshiloh, and passed by it on the east to Janohah;</i></p> <p>7 <i>And it went down from Janohah to Ataroth, and to Naarath, and came to Jericho, and went out at Jordan.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The border went out from Tappuah westward unto the river Kanah; and the goings out thereof were at the sea. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Ephraim by their families.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And the separate cities for the children of Ephraim were among the inheritance of the children of Manasseh, all the cities with their villages.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And they drave not out the Canaanites that dwelt in Gezer: but the Canaanites dwell among the Ephraimites unto this day, and serve under tribute.</i></p> | <p>the boundary goes from there to the sea. On the north is Michmethath. Then on the east the boundary turns around toward Taanath-shiloh and passes along beyond it on the east to Janoah,</p> <p>then it goes down from Janoah to Ataroth and to Naarah, and touches Jericho, ending at the Jordan.</p> <p>From Tappuah the boundary goes westward to the brook Kanah and ends at the sea. Such is the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Ephraim by their clans,</p> <p>together with the towns that were set apart for the people of Ephraim within the inheritance of the people of Manasseh, all those towns with their villages.</p> <p>However, they did not drive out the Canaanites who lived in Gezer, so the Canaanites have lived in the midst of Ephraim to this day but have been made to do forced labor.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 18:12
- v2 — Josh 18:13
- v4 — Josh 17:14
- v5 — Josh 18:13
- v6 — Josh 17:7
- v7 — 1 Chr 7:28

v10 — Judg 1:29; Deut 7:1-2; Josh 17:13; 1 Kgs 9:16

Chapter 17

The territory of the half-tribe of Manasseh west of the Jordan is described, including the inheritance granted to the daughters of Zelophehad. The people of Joseph complained that their allotment was too small, and Joshua told them to clear the forested hill country.

- 1 *There was also a lot for the tribe of Manasseh; for he was the firstborn of Joseph; to wit, for Machir the firstborn of Manasseh, the father of Gilead: because he was a man of war, therefore he had Gilead and Bashan.*

Then allotment was made to the tribe of Manasseh, for he was the firstborn of Joseph. To Machir the firstborn of Manasseh, the father of Gilead, were allotted Gilead and Bashan, because he was a man of war.
- 2 *There was also a lot for the rest of the children of Manasseh by their families; for the children of Abiezer, and for the children of Helek, and for the children of Asriel, and for the children of Shechem, and for the children of Hephher, and for the children of Shemida: these were the male children of Manasseh the son of Joseph by their families.*

allotments were made to the rest of the people of Manasseh by their clans, Abiezer, Helek, Asriel, Shechem, Hephher, and Shemida. These were the male descendants of Manasseh the son of Joseph, by their clans.
- 3 *But Zelophehad, the son of Hephher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, had no sons, but daughters: and these are the names of his daughters, Mahlah, and Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.*

Now Zelophehad the son of Hephher, son of Gilead, son of Machir, son of Manasseh, had no sons, but only daughters, and these are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.

- 4 *And they came near before Eleazar the priest, and before Joshua the son of Nun, and before the princes, saying, The LORD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance among our brethren. Therefore according to the commandment of the LORD he gave them an inheritance among the brethren of their father.* They approached Eleazar the priest and Joshua the son of Nun and the leaders and said, "The LORD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance along with our brothers." So according to the mouth of the LORD He gave them an inheritance among the brothers of their father.
- 5 *And there fell ten portions to Manasseh, beside the land of Gilead and Bashan, which were on the other side Jordan;* Thus there fell to Manasseh ten portions, besides the land of Gilead and Bashan, which is on the other side of the Jordan,
- 6 *Because the daughters of Manasseh had an inheritance among his sons: and the rest of Manasseh's sons had the land of Gilead.* because the daughters of Manasseh received an inheritance along with his sons. The land of Gilead was allotted to the rest of the people of Manasseh.
- 7 *And the coast of Manasseh was from Asher to Michmethah, that lieth before Shechem; and the border went along on the right hand unto the inhabitants of Entappuah.* The territory of Manasseh reached from Asher to Michmethath, which is east of Shechem. Then the boundary goes along southward to the inhabitants of En-tappuah.
- 8 *Now Manasseh had the land of Tappuah: but Tappuah on the border of Manasseh belonged to the children of Ephraim;* The land of Tappuah belonged to Manasseh, but the town of Tappuah on the boundary of Manasseh belonged to the people of Ephraim.
- 9 *And the coast descended unto the river Kanah, southward of the river: these cities of Ephraim are among the cities of Manasseh: the coast of Manasseh also was on the north side of the river, and the outgoings of it were at the sea:* Then the boundary goes down to the brook Kanah. These cities, to the south of the brook, among the cities of Manasseh, belong to Ephraim. Then the boundary of Manasseh goes along the north side of the brook and ends at the sea,

- 10 *Southward it was Ephraim's, and northward it was Manasseh's, and the sea is his border; and they met together in Asher on the north, and in Issachar on the east.* the land to the south being Ephraim's and that to the north being Manasseh's, with the sea forming its boundary. On the north Asher is reached, and on the east Issachar.
- 11 *And Manasseh had in Issachar and in Asher Bethshean and her towns, and Ibleam and her towns, and the inhabitants of Dor and her towns, and the inhabitants of Endor and her towns, and the inhabitants of Taanach and her towns, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and her towns, even three countries.* Also in Issachar and in Asher, Manasseh had Beth-shean and its villages, Ibleam and its villages, the inhabitants of Dor and its villages, the inhabitants of En-dor and its villages, the inhabitants of Taanach and its villages, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and its villages; three countries.
- 12 *Yet the children of Manasseh could not drive out the inhabitants of those cities; but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.* Yet the people of Manasseh could not take possession of those cities, but the Canaanites persisted in dwelling in that land.
- 13 *And it came to pass, when the children of Israel were waxen strong, that they put the Canaanites to tribute; but did not utterly drive them out.* When the people of Israel grew strong, they put the Canaanites to forced labor, but did not utterly drive them out.
- 14 *And the children of Joseph spake unto Joshua, saying, Why hast thou given me but one lot and one portion to inherit, seeing I am a great people, forasmuch as the LORD hath blessed me hitherto?* Then the people of Joseph spoke to Joshua, saying, "Why have you given me but one lot and one portion as an inheritance, although I am a numerous people, since all along the LORD has blessed me?"
- 15 *And Joshua answered them, If thou be a great people, then get thee up to the wood country, and cut down for thyself there in the land of the Perizzites and of the giants, if mount Ephraim be too narrow for thee.* Joshua said to them, "If you are a numerous people, go up by yourselves to the forest, and there clear ground for yourselves in the land of the Perizzites and of the giants, since the hill country of Ephraim is too narrow for you."

- 16 *And the children of Joseph said, The hill is not enough for us: and all the Canaanites that dwell in the land of the valley have chariots of iron, both they who are of Bethshean and her towns, and they who are of the valley of Jezreel.* The people of Joseph said, "The hill country is not enough for us. Yet all the Canaanites who dwell in the plain have chariots of iron, both those in Beth-shean and its villages and those in the Valley of Jezreel."
- 17 *And Joshua spake unto the house of Joseph, even to Ephraim and to Manasseh, saying, Thou art a great people, and hast great power: thou shalt not have one lot only:* Then Joshua said to the house of Joseph, to Ephraim and Manasseh, "You are a numerous people and have great power. You shall not have one allotment only,
- 18 *But the mountain shall be thine; for it is a wood, and thou shalt cut it down: and the outgoings of it shall be thine: for thou shalt drive out the Canaanites, though they have iron chariots, and though they be strong.* but the hill country shall be yours, for though it is a forest, you shall clear it and possess it to its farthest borders. For you shall drive out the Canaanites, though they have iron chariots and though they are strong."

Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Num 26:29; Gen 41:51

v3 — Num 26:33; Num 27:1

v8 — Josh 16:8

v11 — 1 Chr 7:29

v13 — Josh 16:10

v18 — Heb 13:6; Rom 8:31

Chapter 18

The tabernacle was set up at Shiloh, and Joshua sent surveyors to map the remaining land into seven portions. The territory of Benjamin was allotted by lot, situated between Judah and Joseph.

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| 1 <i>And the whole congregation of the children of Israel assembled together at Shiloh, and set up the tabernacle of the congregation there. And the land was subdued before them.</i> | Then the whole congregation of the people of Israel assembled at Shiloh and set up the tent of meeting there. The land lay subdued before them. |
| 2 <i>And there remained among the children of Israel seven tribes, which had not yet received their inheritance.</i> | There remained among the people of Israel seven tribes whose inheritance had not yet been apportioned. |
| 3 <i>And Joshua said unto the children of Israel, How long are ye slack to go to possess the land, which the LORD God of your fathers hath given you?</i> | So Joshua said to the people of Israel, "How long will you put off going in to take possession of the land, which the LORD, the God of Your fathers, has given You? |
| 4 <i>Give out from among you three men for each tribe: and I will send them, and they shall rise, and go through the land, and describe it according to the inheritance of them; and they shall come again to me.</i> | Provide three men from each tribe. I will send them out that they may set out and go up and down the land. They shall write a description of it with a view to their inheritances, and then come to me. |
| 5 <i>And they shall divide it into seven parts: Judah shall abide in their coast on the south, and the house of Joseph shall abide in their coasts on the north.</i> | They shall divide it into seven portions. Judah shall continue in his territory on the south, and the house of Joseph shall continue in their territory on the north. |
| 6 <i>Ye shall therefore describe the land into seven parts, and bring the description hither to me, that I may cast lots for you here before the LORD our God.</i> | you shall describe the land in seven divisions and bring the description here to me. And I will cast lots for You here before the LORD our God. |

- 7 *But the Levites have no part among you; for the priesthood of the LORD is their inheritance: and Gad, and Reuben, and half the tribe of Manasseh, have received their inheritance beyond Jordan on the east, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave them.* The Levites have no portion among You, for the priesthood of the LORD is their heritage. And Gad and Reuben and half the tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance beyond the Jordan eastward, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave them."
- 8 *And the men arose, and went away: and Joshua charged them that went to describe the land, saying, Go and walk through the land, and describe it, and come again to me, that I may here cast lots for you before the LORD in Shiloh.* So the men arose and went, and Joshua charged those who went to write the description of the land, saying, "Go up and down in the land and write a description and return to me. And I will cast lots for You here before the LORD in Shiloh."
- 9 *And the men went and passed through the land, and described it by cities into seven parts in a book, and came again to Joshua to the host at Shiloh.* So the men went and passed up and down in the land and wrote in a book a description of it by towns in seven divisions. Then they came to Joshua to the camp at Shiloh,
- 10 *And Joshua cast lots for them in Shiloh before the LORD: and there Joshua divided the land unto the children of Israel according to their divisions.* Joshua cast lots for them in Shiloh before the LORD. And there Joshua apportioned the land to the people of Israel, to each his portion.
- 11 *And the lot of the tribe of the children of Benjamin came up according to their families: and the coast of their lot came forth between the children of Judah and the children of Joseph.* The lot of the tribe of the people of Benjamin according to its clans came up, and the territory allotted to it fell between the people of Judah and the people of Joseph.

- 12 *And their border on the north side was from Jordan; and the border went up to the side of Jericho on the north side, and went up through the mountains westward; and the goings out thereof were at the wilderness of Bethaven.* On the north side their boundary began at the Jordan. Then the boundary goes up to the shoulder north of Jericho, then up through the hill country westward. It ends at the wilderness of Beth-aven.
- 13 *And the border went over from thence toward Luz, to the side of Luz, which is Bethel, southward; and the border descended to Atarothadar, near the hill that lieth on the south side of the nether Bethharon.* From there the boundary passes along southward in the direction of Luz, to the shoulder of Luz (that is, Bethel), then the boundary goes down to Ataroth-addar, on the mountain that lies south of Lower Beth-horon.
- 14 *And the border was drawn thence, and compassed the corner of the sea southward, from the hill that lieth before Bethharon southward; and the goings out thereof were at Kirjathbaal, which is Kirjathjearim, a city of the children of Judah: this was the west quarter.* Then the boundary goes in another direction, turning on the west side southward from the mountain that lies to the south, opposite Beth-horon. It ends at Kiriath-baal (that is, Kiriath-jearim), a city of the people of Judah. This forms the western side.
- 15 *And the south quarter was from the end of Kirjathjearim, and the border went out on the west, and went out to the well of waters of Nephtoah:* the south side begins at the outskirts of Kiriath-jearim. And the boundary goes from there to Ephron, to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah.
- 16 *And the border came down to the end of the mountain that lieth before the valley of the son of Hinnom, and which is in the valley of the giants on the north, and descended to the valley of Hinnom, to the side of Jebusi on the south, and descended to Enrogel,* Then the boundary goes down to the border of the mountain that overlooks the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, which is at the north end of the valley of the giants. And it then goes down the Valley of Hinnom, south of the shoulder of the Jebusites, and downward to En-rogel.

- 17 *And was drawn from the north, and went forth to Enshemesh, and went forth toward Geliloth, which is over against the going up of Adummim, and descended to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben,* Then it bends in a northerly direction going on to En-shemesh, and from there goes to Geliloth, which is opposite the ascent of Adummim. Then it goes down to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben.
- 18 *And passed along toward the side over against Arabah northward, and went down unto Arabah:* passing on to the north side of the shoulder of Beth-arabah, it goes down to the Arabah.
- 19 *And the border passed along to the side of Bethhoglah northward: and the outgoings of the border were at the north bay of the salt sea at the south end of Jordan: this was the south coast.* Then the boundary passes on to the north shoulder of Beth-hoglah. And the boundary ends at the northern bay of the Salt Sea, at the south end of the Jordan: this is the southern boundary.
- 20 *And Jordan was the border of it on the east side. This was the inheritance of the children of Benjamin, by the coasts thereof round about, according to their families.* The Jordan forms its boundary on the east side. This is the inheritance of the people of Benjamin, according to their clans, boundary by boundary all around.
- 21 *Now the cities of the tribe of the children of Benjamin according to their families were Jericho, and Bethhoglah, and the valley of Keziz,* Now the cities of the tribe of the people of Benjamin according to their clans were Jericho, Beth-hoglah, Emek-keziz,
- 22 *And Betharabah, and Zemaraim, and Bethel,* Beth-arabah, Zemaraim, Bethel,
- 23 *And Avim, and Parah, and Ophrah,* Avvim, Parah, Ophrah,
- 24 *And Chepharhammonai, and Ophni, and Gaba; twelve cities with their villages:* Chephar-ammoni, Ophni, Geba—twelve cities with their villages.
- 25 *Gibeon, and Ramah, and Beeroth,* Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth,
- 26 *And Mizpeh, and Chephirah, and Mozah,* Mizpeh, Chephirah, Mozah,
- 27 *And Rekem, and Irpeel, and Taralah,* Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah,

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And Zelah, Eleph, and Jebusi, which is Jerusalem, Gibeath, and Kirjath; fourteen cities with their villages. This is the inheritance of the children of Benjamin according to their families.
- Zela, Haeleph, Jebus (that is, Jerusalem), Gibeah and Kiriath-jearim—fourteen cities with their villages. This is the inheritance of the people of Benjamin according to their clans.

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Josh 19:51; Josh 21:2; 1 Sam 1:3
- v3** — Prov 13:4; Prov 15:19; Judg 18:9; Matt 20:6; Prov 10:4
- v6** — Josh 14:2
- v7** — Josh 13:33
- v10** — Col 1:12
- v12** — Josh 16:1
- v16** — 2 Kgs 23:10
- v17** — Josh 15:6
- v28** — 2 Sam 21:14

Chapter 19

The remaining six tribes—Simeon, Zebulun, Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and Dan—received their allotments by lot. Joshua himself received the city of Timnath-serah in the hill country of Ephraim.

- 1

And the second lot came forth to Simeon, even for the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families: and their inheritance was within the inheritance of the children of Judah.
- The second lot came out for Simeon, for the tribe of the people of Simeon, according to their clans. Their inheritance was in the midst of the inheritance of the people of Judah.
- 2

And they had in their inheritance Beersheba, and Sheba, and Moladah,
- they had for their inheritance Beersheba, Sheba, Moladah,

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| 3 | <i>And Hazarshual, and Balah, and Azem,</i> | Hazar-shual, Balah, Ezem, |
| 4 | <i>And Eltolad, and Bethul, and Hormah,</i> | Eltolad, Bethul, Hormah, |
| 5 | <i>And Ziklag, and Bethmarcaboth, and Hazarsusah,</i> | Ziklag, Beth-marcaboth, Hazar-susah, |
| 6 | <i>And Bethlebaoth, and Sharuhem; thirteen cities and their villages:</i> | Beth-lebaoth, and Sharuhem—thirteen cities with their villages; |
| 7 | <i>Ain, Remmon, and Ether, and Ashan; four cities and their villages:</i> | Ain, Rimmon, Ether, and Ashan—four cities with their villages; |
| 8 | <i>And all the villages that were round about these cities to Baalathbeer, Ramath of the south. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families.</i> | together with all the villages around these cities as far as Baalath-beer, Ramath of the south. This was the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Simeon according to their clans. |
| 9 | <i>Out of the portion of the children of Judah was the inheritance of the children of Simeon: for the part of the children of Judah was too much for them: therefore the children of Simeon had their inheritance within the inheritance of them.</i> | The inheritance of the people of Simeon formed part of the territory of the people of Judah. Because the portion of the people of Judah was too large for them, the people of Simeon obtained an inheritance in the midst of their inheritance. |
| 10 | <i>And the third lot came up for the children of Zebulun according to their families: and the border of their inheritance was unto Sarid.</i> | The third lot came up for the people of Zebulun, according to their clans. And the boundary of their inheritance reached as far as Sarid. |
| 11 | <i>And their border went up toward the sea, and Maralah, and reached to Dabbasheth, and reached to the river that is before Jokneam;</i> | Their border went up westward toward Maralah and reached as far as Dabbesheth, then reached the brook that is before Jokneam. |
| 12 | <i>And turned from Sarid eastward toward the sunrising unto the border of Chislothabor, and then goeth out to Daberath, and goeth up to Japhia,</i> | From Sarid it turned eastward toward the sunrising to the border of Chisloth-tabor, then went out to Daberath and up to Japhia. |

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| <p>13 <i>And from thence passeth on along on the east to Gittahhepher, to Ittahkazin, and goeth out to Remmonmethoar to Neah;</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the border compasseth it on the north side to Hannathon: and the outgoings thereof are in the valley of Jiphtahel:</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Kattath, and Nahallal, and Shimron, and Idalah, and Bethlehem: twelve cities with their villages.</i></p> <p>16 <i>This is the inheritance of the children of Zebulun according to their families, these cities with their villages.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the fourth lot came out to Issachar, for the children of Issachar according to their families.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And their border was toward Jezreel, and Chesulloth, and Shunem,</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Hapharaim, and Shihon, and Anaharath,</i></p> <p>20 <i>And Rabbith, and Kishion, and Abez,</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Remeth, and Engannim, and Enhaddah, and Bethpazzez;</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the coast reacheth to Tabor, and Shahazimah, and Bethshemesh; and the outgoings of their border were at Jordan: sixteen cities with their villages.</i></p> <p>23 <i>This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Issachar according to their families, the cities and their villages.</i></p> | <p>From there it passed along on the east to Gath-hepher, to Eth-kazin, and went out to Rimmon, bending toward Neah.</p> <p>The border circled around it on the north to Hannathon, and ended in the valley of Iphtahel.</p> <p>It also included Kattath, Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah, and Bethlehem — twelve cities with their villages.</p> <p>This was the inheritance of the people of Zebulun according to their clans — these cities with their villages.</p> <p>The fourth lot came out for Issachar, for the people of Issachar, according to their clans.</p> <p>Their territory included Jezreel, Chesulloth, Shunem,</p> <p>Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath,</p> <p>Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez,</p> <p>Remeth, En-gannim, En-haddah, and Beth-pazzez.</p> <p>The border reached to Tabor, Shahazumah, and Beth-shemesh, and ended at the Jordan — sixteen cities with their villages.</p> <p>This was the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Issachar, according to their clans — the cities and their villages.</p> |
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- 24 *And the fifth lot came out for the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families.* The fifth lot came out for the tribe of the people of Asher according to their clans.
- 25 *And their border was Helkath, and Hali, and Beten, and Achshaph,* Their territory included Helkath, Hali, Beten, Achshaph,
- 26 *And Allammelech, and Amad, and Misheal; and reacheth to Carmel westward, and to Shihorlibnath;* Allammelech, Amad, and Mishal; and it reached to Carmel on the west and to Shihor-libnath.
- 27 *And turneth toward the sunrising to Bethdagon, and reacheth to Zebulun, and to the valley of Jiphtahel toward the north side of Bethemek, and Neiel, and goeth out to Cabul on the left hand,* Then it turned toward the sunrising to Beth-dagon and reached to Zebulun and to the valley of Iphtahel northward to Beth-emek and Neiel, then went out to Cabul on the north,
- 28 *And Hebron, and Rehob, and Hammon, and Kanah, even unto great Zidon;* with Ebron, Rehob, Hammon, and Kanah, as far as great Zidon.
- 29 *And then the coast turneth to Ramah, and to the strong city Tyre; and the coast turneth to Hosah; and the outgoings thereof are at the sea from the coast to Achzib:* Then the boundary turned to Ramah and to the fortified city of Tyre, and turned to Hosah, ending at the sea in the region of Achzib,
- 30 *Ummah also, and Aphek, and Rehob: twenty and two cities with their villages.* Ummah also, Aphek, and Rehob — twenty-two cities with their villages.
- 31 *This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families, these cities with their villages.* This was the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Asher, according to their clans — these cities with their villages.
- 32 *The sixth lot came out to the children of Naphtali, even for the children of Naphtali according to their families.* The sixth lot came out for the people of Naphtali, for the people of Naphtali, according to their clans.

- 33 *And their coast was from Heleph, from Allon to Zaanannim, and Adami, Nekeb, and Jabneel, unto Lakum; and the outgoings thereof were at Jordan:* Their border ran from Heleph, from the oak in Zaanannim, and from Adami-nekeb and Jabneel as far as Lakkum, ending at the Jordan.
- 34 *And then the coast turneth westward to Aznohtabor, and goeth out from thence to Hukkok, and reacheth to Zebulun on the south side, and reacheth to Asher on the west side, and to Judah upon Jordan toward the sunrising.* Then the border turned westward to Aznoth-tabor and went out from there to Hukkok, reaching to Zebulun on the south, to Asher on the west, and to Judah at the Jordan toward the sunrising.
- 35 *And the fenced cities are Ziddim, Zer, and Hammath, Rakkath, and Chinnereth,* The fortified cities were Ziddim, Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, Chinnereth,
- 36 *And Adamah, and Ramah, and Hazor,* Adamah, Ramah, Hazor,
- 37 *And Kedesh, and Edrei, and Enhazor,* Kedesh, Edrei, En-hazor,
- 38 *And Iron, and Migdalel, Horem, and Bethanath, and Bethshemesh; nineteen cities with their villages.* Iron, Migdal-el, Horem, Beth-anath, and Beth-shemesh — nineteen cities with their villages.
- 39 *This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Naphtali according to their families, the cities and their villages.* This was the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Naphtali, according to their clans — the cities and their villages.
- 40 *And the seventh lot came out for the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families.* The seventh lot came out for the tribe of the people of Dan, according to their clans.
- 41 *And the coast of their inheritance was Zorah, and Eshtaol, and Irshemesh,* The territory of their inheritance included Zorah, Eshtaol, Ir-shemesh,
- 42 *And Shaalabbin, and Ajalon, and Jethlah,* Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah,
- 43 *And Elon, and Thimnathah, and Ekron,* Elon, Timnah, Ekron,
- 44 *And Eltekeh, and Gibbethon, and Baalath,* Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath,

- 45 *And Jehud, and Beneberak, and Gathrimmon,* Jehud, Bene-berak, Gath-rimmon,
- 46 *And Mejarkon, and Rakkon, with the border before Japho.* Me-jarkon, and Rakkon, with the territory over against Joppa.
- 47 *And the coast of the children of Dan went out too little for them: therefore the children of Dan went up to fight against Leshem, and took it, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and possessed it, and dwelt therein, and called Leshem, Dan, after the name of Dan their father.* When the territory of the people of Dan was lost to them, the people of Dan went up and fought against Leshem, and after capturing it and striking it with the sword they possessed it and settled in it, calling Leshem, Dan, after the name of Dan their ancestor.
- 48 *This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families, these cities with their villages.* This is the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Dan, according to their clans—these cities with their villages.
- 49 *When they had made an end of dividing the land for inheritance by their coasts, the children of Israel gave an inheritance to Joshua the son of Nun among them:* When they had finished distributing the several territories of the land as inheritances, the people of Israel gave an inheritance among them to Joshua the son of Nun.
- 50 *According to the word of the LORD they gave him the city which he asked, even Timnathserah in mount Ephraim: and he built the city, and dwelt therein.* By command of the LORD they gave Him the city that He asked, Timnath-serah in the hill country of Ephraim. And He rebuilt the city and lived in it.
- 51 *These are the inheritances, which Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel, divided for an inheritance by lot in Shiloh before the LORD, at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation. So they made an end of dividing the country.* These are the inheritances that Eleazar the priest and Joshua the son of Nun and the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the people of Israel distributed by lot at Shiloh before the LORD, at the entrance of the tent of meeting. So they finished dividing the land.

Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Cross-References:

v18 — 1 Sam 28:4

v27 — 1 Kgs 9:13

v28 — Judg 1:31

v51 — Josh 14:1; Josh 18:10

Chapter 20

Six cities of refuge were designated—three west of the Jordan and three east—where anyone who killed a person accidentally could flee and be safe from the avenger of blood.

- 1 *The LORD also spake unto Joshua,* Then the LORD said to Joshua, saying,
- 2 *Speak to the children of Israel, saying,* "Say to the people of Israel, 'Appoint
Appoint out for you cities of refuge, the cities of refuge, of which I spoke to
whereof I spake unto you by the hand you through Moses,
of Moses:
- 3 *That the slayer that killeth any person* that the manslayer who strikes any
unawares and unwittingly may flee person without intent or unknowingly
thither: and they shall be your refuge may flee there. They shall be for you a
from the avenger of blood. refuge from the avenger of blood.
- 4 *And when he that doth flee unto one of* He shall flee to one of these cities and
those cities shall stand at the entering shall stand at the entrance of the gate
of the gate of the city, and shall of the city and explain his case to the
declare his cause in the ears of the elders of that city. Then they shall take
elders of that city, they shall take him him into the city and give him a place.
into the city unto them, and give him a He shall remain with them.
place, that he may dwell among them.

- 5 *And if the avenger of blood pursue after him, then they shall not deliver the slayer up into his hand; because he smote his neighbour unwittingly, and hated him not beforetime.* if the avenger of blood pursues him, they shall not give up the manslayer into his hand, because he struck his neighbor unknowingly, and did not hate him in the past.
- 6 *And he shall dwell in that city, until he stand before the congregation for judgment, and until the death of the high priest that shall be in those days: then shall the slayer return, and come unto his own city, and unto his own house, unto the city from whence he fled.* he shall remain in that city until he stands before the congregation for judgment, until the death of him who is high priest at the time. Then the manslayer may return to his own town and his own home, to the town from which he fled.' "
- 7 *And they appointed Kedesh in Galilee in mount Naphtali, and Shechem in mount Ephraim, and Kirjatharba, which is Hebron, in the mountain of Judah.* So they set apart Kedesh in Galilee in the hill country of Naphtali, and Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim, and Kiriath-arba (that is, Hebron) in the hill country of Judah.
- 8 *And on the other side Jordan by Jericho eastward, they assigned Bezer in the wilderness upon the plain out of the tribe of Reuben, and Ramoth in Gilead out of the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan out of the tribe of Manasseh.* beyond the Jordan east of Jericho, they appointed Bezer in the wilderness on the tableland, from the tribe of Reuben, and Ramoth in Gilead, from the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan, from the tribe of Manasseh.
- 9 *These were the cities appointed for all the children of Israel, and for the stranger that sojourneth among them, that whosoever killeth any person at unawares might flee thither, and not die by the hand of the avenger of blood, until he stood before the congregation.* These were the cities designated for all the people of Israel and for the stranger sojourning among them, that anyone who killed a person without intent could flee there, so that he might not die by the hand of the avenger of blood, till he stood before the congregation.

Words in this chapter:

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Deut 19:2-13; Deut 4:41-43; Num 35:11-24; Num 35:6
v6 — Num 35:12
v7 — Josh 21:11; Luke 1:39; Josh 21:32; 1 Chr 6:76
v9 — Num 35:15

Chapter 21

Forty-eight cities with pasturelands were given to the Levites from the territories of the other tribes. The LORD gave Israel all the land He had sworn to their fathers, and not one word of His promises failed.

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| <p>1 <i>Then came near the heads of the fathers of the Levites unto Eleazar the priest, and unto Joshua the son of Nun, and unto the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel;</i></p> | <p>Then the heads of the fathers' houses of the Levites came to Eleazar the priest and to Joshua the son of Nun and to the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the people of Israel.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And they spake unto them at Shiloh in the land of Canaan, saying, The LORD commanded by the hand of Moses to give us cities to dwell in, with the suburbs thereof for our cattle.</i></p> | <p>they said to them at Shiloh in the land of Canaan, "The LORD commanded through Moses that we be given cities to dwell in, along with their pasturelands for our livestock."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And the children of Israel gave unto the Levites out of their inheritance, at the commandment of the LORD, these cities and their suburbs.</i></p> | <p>So the people of Israel gave to the Levites, out of their inheritance, by command of the LORD, these cities and their pasturelands.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the lot came out for the families of the Kohathites: and the children of Aaron the priest, which were of the Levites, had by lot out of the tribe of Judah, and out of the tribe of Simeon, and out of the tribe of Benjamin, thirteen cities.</i></p> | <p>The lot came out for the clans of the Kohathites. So those Levites who were descendants of Aaron the priest received by lot thirteen cities from the tribe of Judah, the tribe of Simeon, and the tribe of Benjamin.</p> |

- 5 *And the rest of the children of Kohath had by lot out of the families of the tribe of Ephraim, and out of the tribe of Dan, and out of the half tribe of Manasseh, ten cities.* the rest of the Kohathites received by lot from the clans of the tribe of Ephraim, from the tribe of Dan, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, ten cities.
- 6 *And the children of Gershon had by lot out of the families of the tribe of Issachar, and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the half tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.* The Gershonites received by lot from the clans of the tribe of Issachar, from the tribe of Asher, from the tribe of Naphtali, and from the half-tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.
- 7 *The children of Merari by their families had out of the tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.* The Merarites according to their clans received from the tribe of Reuben, the tribe of Gad, and the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.
- 8 *And the children of Israel gave by lot unto the Levites these cities with their suburbs, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.* These cities and their pasturelands the people of Israel gave by lot to the Levites, as the LORD had commanded through Moses.
- 9 *And they gave out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, these cities which are here mentioned by name,* Out of the tribe of the people of Judah and out of the tribe of the people of Simeon they gave these cities which are mentioned by name,
- 10 *Which the children of Aaron, being of the families of the Kohathites, who were of the children of Levi, had: for theirs was the first lot.* which went to the descendants of Aaron of the clans of the Kohathites, who were of the people of Levi, for theirs was the first lot.
- 11 *And they gave them the city of Arba the father of Anak, which city is Hebron, in the hill country of Judah, with the suburbs thereof round about it.* They gave them Kiriath-arba (Arba being the father of Anak), that is, Hebron, in the hill country of Judah, with the pasturelands around it.

- 12 *But the fields of the city, and the villages thereof, gave they to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for his possession.* But the fields of the city and its villages they gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh as his possession.
- 13 *Thus they gave to the children of Aaron the priest Hebron with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Libnah with her suburbs,* Thus they gave to the descendants of Aaron the priest Hebron with its pasturelands, the city of refuge for the slayer, and Libnah with its pasturelands,
- 14 *And Jattir with her suburbs, and Eshtemoa with her suburbs,* Jattir with its pasturelands, Eshtemoa with its pasturelands,
- 15 *And Holon with her suburbs, and Debir with her suburbs,* Holon with its pasturelands, Debir with its pasturelands,
- 16 *And Ain with her suburbs, and Juttah with her suburbs, and Bethshemesh with her suburbs; nine cities out of those two tribes.* Ain with its pasturelands, Juttah with its pasturelands, and Beth-shemesh with its pasturelands — nine cities out of those two tribes.
- 17 *And out of the tribe of Benjamin, Gibeon with her suburbs, Geba with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Benjamin: Gibeon with its pasturelands, Geba with its pasturelands,
- 18 *Anathoth with her suburbs, and Almon with her suburbs; four cities.* Anathoth with its pasturelands, and Almon with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 19 *All the cities of the children of Aaron, the priests, were thirteen cities with their suburbs.* The cities of the descendants of Aaron the priests were thirteen in all, with their pasturelands.
- 20 *And the families of the children of Kohath, the Levites which remained of the children of Kohath, even they had the cities of their lot out of the tribe of Ephraim.* The clans of the Kohathites — the Levites who remained of the Kohathites — received the cities of their lot from the tribe of Ephraim.

- 21 *For they gave them Shechem with her suburbs in mount Ephraim, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Gezer with her suburbs,* They gave them Shechem with its pasturelands in the hill country of Ephraim, the city of refuge for the slayer, and Gezer with its pasturelands,
- 22 *And Kibzaim with her suburbs, and Bethhoron with her suburbs; four cities.* Kibzaim with its pasturelands, and Beth-horon with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 23 *And out of the tribe of Dan, Eltekeh with her suburbs, Gibbethon with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Dan: Elteke with its pasturelands, Gibbethon with its pasturelands,
- 24 *Aijalon with her suburbs, Gathrimmon with her suburbs; four cities.* Aijalon with its pasturelands, and Gath-rimmon with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 25 *And out of the half tribe of Manasseh, Tanach with her suburbs, and Gathrimmon with her suburbs; two cities.* Out of the half-tribe of Manasseh: Taanach with its pasturelands, and Gath-rimmon with its pasturelands — two cities.
- 26 *All the cities were ten with their suburbs for the families of the children of Kohath that remained.* All the cities of the remaining clans of the Kohathites were ten, with their pasturelands.
- 27 *And unto the children of Gershon, of the families of the Levites, out of the other half tribe of Manasseh they gave Golan in Bashan with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Beeshterah with her suburbs; two cities.* To the Gershonites, one of the clans of the Levites, out of the other half-tribe of Manasseh, they gave Golan in Bashan with its pasturelands, the city of refuge for the slayer, and Beeshterah with its pasturelands — two cities.
- 28 *And out of the tribe of Issachar, Kishon with her suburbs, Dabareh with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Issachar: Kishion with its pasturelands, Daberath with its pasturelands,
- 29 *Jarmuth with her suburbs, Engannim with her suburbs; four cities.* Jarmuth with its pasturelands, and En-gannim with its pasturelands — four cities.

- 30 *And out of the tribe of Asher, Mishal with her suburbs, Abdon with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Asher: Mishal with its pasturelands, Abdon with its pasturelands,
- 31 *Helkath with her suburbs, and Rehob with her suburbs; four cities.* Helkath with its pasturelands, and Rehob with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 32 *And out of the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Hammothdor with her suburbs, and Kartan with her suburbs; three cities.* Out of the tribe of Naphtali: Kedesh in Galilee with its pasturelands, the city of refuge for the slayer, Hammoth-dor with its pasturelands, and Kartan with its pasturelands — three cities.
- 33 *All the cities of the Gershonites according to their families were thirteen cities with their suburbs.* All the cities of the Gershonites according to their clans were thirteen, with their pasturelands.
- 34 *And unto the families of the children of Merari, the rest of the Levites, out of the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam with her suburbs, and Kartah with her suburbs,* To the clans of the descendants of Merari, the rest of the Levites, out of the tribe of Zebulun: Jokneam with its pasturelands, Kartah with its pasturelands,
- 35 *Dimnah with her suburbs, Nahalal with her suburbs; four cities.* Dimnah with its pasturelands, and Nahalal with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 36 *And out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer with her suburbs, and Jahazah with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Reuben: Bezer with its pasturelands, Jahzah with its pasturelands,
- 37 *Kedemoth with her suburbs, and Mephaath with her suburbs; four cities.* Kedemoth with its pasturelands, and Mephaath with its pasturelands — four cities.
- 38 *And out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Mahanaim with her suburbs,* Out of the tribe of Gad: Ramoth in Gilead with its pasturelands, the city of refuge for the slayer, Mahanaim with its pasturelands,

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| 39 | <i>Heshbon with her suburbs, Jazer with her suburbs; four cities in all.</i> | Heshbon with its pasturelands, and Jazer with its pasturelands — four cities in all. |
| 40 | <i>So all the cities for the children of Merari by their families, which were remaining of the families of the Levites, were by lot twelve cities.</i> | All the cities of the descendants of Merari, according to their clans, the rest of the clans of the Levites — those allotted to them — were twelve cities in all. |
| 41 | <i>All the cities of the Levites within the possession of the children of Israel were forty and eight cities with their suburbs.</i> | All the cities of the Levites within the possession of the people of Israel were forty-eight cities with their pasturelands. |
| 42 | <i>These cities were every one with their suburbs round about them: thus were all these cities.</i> | These cities each had its pasturelands around it. So it was with all these cities. |
| 43 | <i>And the LORD gave unto Israel all the land which he sware to give unto their fathers; and they possessed it, and dwelt therein.</i> | Thus the LORD gave to Israel all the land that He swore to give to their fathers. And they took possession of it. They settled there. |
| 44 | <i>And the LORD gave them rest round about, according to all that he sware unto their fathers: and there stood not a man of all their enemies before them; the LORD delivered all their enemies into their hand.</i> | the LORD gave them rest on every side just as He had sworn to their fathers. Not one of all their enemies had withstood them, for the LORD had given all their enemies into their hands. |
| 45 | <i>There failed not ought of any good thing which the LORD had spoken unto the house of Israel; all came to pass.</i> | Not one word of all the good promises that the LORD had made to the house of Israel had failed; all came to pass. |

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v11 — 1 Chr 6:55

v21 — Josh 20:7

v34 — 1 Chr 6:77

v36 — Josh 20:8

v43 — Gen 13:15; Ps 106:42-45; Ex 23:27-31; Gen 28:4; Ps 44:3

v44 — Josh 11:23; Deut 31:3-5; Heb 4:9

v45 — 1 Kgs 8:56; Josh 23:14-15; Num 23:19; 1 Thess 5:24; 1 Cor 1:9

Chapter 22

Joshua sent the eastern tribes home with his blessing, and they built a large altar by the Jordan. The western tribes nearly went to war over it, but learned the altar was a memorial witness, not for rival sacrifice, and the conflict was peacefully resolved.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Joshua called the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh,</i></p> | <p>At that time Joshua summoned the Reubenites and the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And said unto them, Ye have kept all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, and have obeyed my voice in all that I commanded you:</i></p> | <p>said to them, "You have kept all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded You and have obeyed my voice in all that I have commanded You.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Ye have not left your brethren these many days unto this day, but have kept the charge of the commandment of the LORD your God.</i></p> | <p>You have not forsaken Your brothers these many days, down to this day, but have been careful to keep the charge of the LORD Your God.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And now the LORD your God hath given rest unto your brethren, as he promised them: therefore now return ye, and get you unto your tents, and unto the land of your possession, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave you on the other side Jordan.</i></p> | <p>now the LORD Your God has given rest to Your brothers, as He promised them. Therefore turn and go to Your tents in the land where Your possession lies, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave You on the other side of the Jordan.</p> |

- 5 *But take diligent heed to do the commandment and the law, which Moses the servant of the LORD charged you, to love the LORD your God, and to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, and to cleave unto him, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul.* Only be very careful to observe the commandment and the law that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded You, to love the LORD Your God, and to walk in all His ways and to keep His commandments and to hold fast to Him and to serve Him with all Your heart and with all Your soul."
- 6 *So Joshua blessed them, and sent them away: and they went unto their tents.* So Joshua blessed them and sent them away. They went to their tents.
- 7 *Now to the one half of the tribe of Manasseh Moses had given possession in Bashan: but unto the other half thereof gave Joshua among their brethren on this side Jordan westward. And when Joshua sent them away also unto their tents, then he blessed them,* Now to the one half of the tribe of Manasseh Moses had given a possession in Bashan, but to the other half Joshua had given a possession beside their brothers on the west side of the Jordan. And when Joshua sent them away to their tents and blessed them,
- 8 *And he spake unto them, saying, Return with much riches unto your tents, and with very much cattle, with silver, and with gold, and with brass, and with iron, and with very much raiment: divide the spoil of your enemies with your brethren.* he said to them, "Go back to your tents with much wealth and with very much livestock, with silver, gold, bronze, and iron, and with much clothing. Divide the spoil of your enemies with your brothers."
- 9 *And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh returned, and departed from the children of Israel out of Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go unto the country of Gilead, to the land of their possession, whereof they were possessed, according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.* So the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh returned home, parting from the people of Israel at Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go to the land of Gilead, their own land of which they had possessed themselves by command of the LORD through Moses.

- 10 *And when they came unto the borders of Jordan, that are in the land of Canaan, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh built there an altar by Jordan, a great altar to see to.* when they came to the region of the Jordan that is in the land of Canaan, the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh built there an altar by the Jordan, an altar of imposing size.
- 11 *And the children of Israel heard say, Behold, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh have built an altar over against the land of Canaan, in the borders of Jordan, at the passage of the children of Israel.* the people of Israel heard it said, " the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh have built the altar at the frontier of the land of Canaan, in the region about the Jordan, on the side that belongs to the people of Israel."
- 12 *And when the children of Israel heard of it, the whole congregation of the children of Israel gathered themselves together at Shiloh, to go up to war against them.* when the people of Israel heard of it, the whole assembly of the people of Israel gathered at Shiloh to make war against them.
- 13 *And the children of Israel sent unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest,* Then the people of Israel sent to the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest,
- 14 *And with him ten princes, of each chief house a prince throughout all the tribes of Israel; and each one was an head of the house of their fathers among the thousands of Israel.* with him ten chiefs, one from each of the tribal families of Israel, every one of them the head of a family among the clans of Israel.
- 15 *And they came unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half tribe of Manasseh, unto the land of Gilead, and they spake with them, saying,* they came to the people of Reuben, the people of Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, in the land of Gilead. They said to them,

- 16 *Thus saith the whole congregation of the LORD, What trespass is this that ye have committed against the God of Israel, to turn away this day from following the LORD, in that ye have builded you an altar, that ye might rebel this day against the LORD?* "Thus says the whole congregation of the LORD, 'What is this breach of faith that You have committed against the God of Israel in turning away today from following the LORD by building yourselves an altar this day in rebellion against the LORD?
- 17 *Is the iniquity of Peor too little for us, from which we are not cleansed until this day, although there was a plague in the congregation of the LORD,* Have we not had enough of the sin at Peor from which even yet we have not cleansed ourselves, and for which there came a plague upon the congregation of the LORD,
- 18 *But that ye must turn away this day from following the LORD? and it will be, seeing ye rebel to day against the LORD, that to morrow he will be wroth with the whole congregation of Israel.* that You must turn away today from following the LORD? And if You rebel today against the LORD, tomorrow He will be angry with the whole congregation of Israel.
- 19 *Notwithstanding, if the land of your possession be unclean, then pass ye over unto the land of the possession of the LORD, wherein the LORD's tabernacle dwelleth, and take possession among us: but rebel not against the LORD, nor rebel against us, in building you an altar beside the altar of the LORD our God.* But now, if the land of Your possession is unclean, pass over into the LORD's land where the LORD's tabernacle stands, and take for yourselves a possession among us. Only do not rebel against the LORD or make us as rebels by building for yourselves an altar other than the altar of the LORD our God.
- 20 *Did not Achan the son of Zerah commit a trespass in the accursed thing, and wrath fell on all the congregation of Israel? and that man perished not alone in his iniquity.* Did not Achan the son of Zerah break faith in the matter of the devoted things, and wrath fell upon all the congregation of Israel? And He did not perish alone for His iniquity.' "

- 21 *Then the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh answered, and said unto the heads of the thousands of Israel,* Then the people of Reuben, the people of Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh said in answer to the heads of the families of Israel,
- 22 *The LORD God of gods, the LORD God of gods, he knoweth, and Israel he shall know; if it be in rebellion, or if in transgression against the LORD, save us not this day,* "The LORD God of gods, the LORD God of gods, He knows. Let Israel itself know! If it was in rebellion or in breach of faith against the LORD, do not spare us today
- 23 *That we have built us an altar to turn from following the LORD, or if to offer thereon burnt offering or meat offering, or if to offer peace offerings thereon, let the LORD himself require it;* for building an altar to turn away from following the LORD. Or if we did so to offer burnt offerings or grain offerings or peace offerings on it, may the LORD Himself take vengeance.
- 24 *And if we have not rather done it for fear of this thing, saying, In time to come your children might speak unto our children, saying, What have ye to do with the LORD God of Israel?* No, but we did it from fear that in time to come Your children might say to our children, 'What have You to do with the LORD, the God of Israel?
- 25 *For the LORD hath made Jordan a border between us and you, ye children of Reuben and children of Gad; ye have no part in the LORD: so shall your children make our children cease from fearing the LORD.* For the LORD has made the Jordan a boundary between us and You, You people of Reuben and people of Gad. You have no portion in the LORD.' So Your children might make our children cease to worship the LORD.
- 26 *Therefore we said, Let us now prepare to build us an altar, not for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice:* Therefore we said, 'Let us now build an altar, not for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice,

- 27 *But that it may be a witness between us, and you, and our generations after us, that we might do the service of the LORD before him with our burnt offerings, and with our sacrifices, and with our peace offerings; that your children may not say to our children in time to come, Ye have no part in the LORD.* but to be a witness between us and You, and between our generations after us, that we do perform the service of the LORD in His presence with our burnt offerings and sacrifices and peace offerings, so Your children will not say to our children in time to come, "You have no portion in the LORD."
- 28 *Therefore said we, that it shall be, when they should so say to us or to our generations in time to come, that we may say again, Behold the pattern of the altar of the LORD, which our fathers made, not for burnt offerings, nor for sacrifices; but it is a witness between us and you.* we thought, 'If this should be said to us or to our descendants in time to come, we should say, 'Look at the pattern of the altar of the LORD, which our fathers made, not for burnt offerings, nor for sacrifice, but to be a witness between us and You.'
- 29 *God forbid that we should rebel against the LORD, and turn this day from following the LORD, to build an altar for burnt offerings, for meat offerings, or for sacrifices, beside the altar of the LORD our God that is before his tabernacle.* Far be it from us that we should rebel against the LORD and turn away this day from following the LORD by building an altar for burnt offering, grain offering, or sacrifice, other than the altar of the LORD our God that stands before His tabernacle!"
- 30 *And when Phinehas the priest, and the princes of the congregation and heads of the thousands of Israel which were with him, heard the words that the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the children of Manasseh spake, it pleased them.* When Phinehas the priest and the chiefs of the congregation, the heads of the families of Israel who were with him, heard the words that the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the people of Manasseh spoke, it was good in their eyes.

- 31 *And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest said unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the children of Manasseh, This day we perceive that the LORD is among us, because ye have not committed this trespass against the LORD: now ye have delivered the children of Israel out of the hand of the LORD.* Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest said to the people of Reuben and the people of Gad and the people of Manasseh, "Today we know that the LORD is in our midst, because You have not committed this breach of faith against the LORD. Now You have delivered the people of Israel from the hand of the LORD."
- 32 *And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, and the princes, returned from the children of Reuben, and from the children of Gad, out of the land of Gilead, unto the land of Canaan, to the children of Israel, and brought them word again.* Then Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, and the chiefs, returned from the people of Reuben and the people of Gad in the land of Gilead to the land of Canaan, to the people of Israel, and brought back word to them.
- 33 *And the thing pleased the children of Israel; and the children of Israel blessed God, and did not intend to go up against them in battle, to destroy the land wherein the children of Reuben and Gad dwelt.* the report was good in the eyes of the people of Israel. And the people of Israel blessed God and spoke no more of making war against them to destroy the land where the people of Reuben and the people of Gad were settled.
- 34 *And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad called the altar Ed: for it shall be a witness between us that the LORD is God.* The people of Reuben and the people of Gad called the altar Witness, "For," they said, "it is a witness between us that the LORD is God."

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Cross-References:

- v5 — Matt 22:37; Ex 20:6; Rom 8:28; Ex 15:26; Deut 11:22
- v6 — Josh 14:13
- v8 — Num 31:27
- v9 — Num 32:29; Num 32:26
- v13 — Num 25:7
- v14 — Num 1:4
- v17 — Ps 106:28-29; Num 25:1-18
- v18 — Num 16:22
- v20 — Josh 7:1; Josh 7:5
- v22 — 1 Kgs 8:39; Ps 44:21; Deut 10:17
- v27 — Josh 24:27; Gen 31:48
- v33 — Dan 2:19; 1 Chr 29:20; Luke 2:28

Chapter 23

Joshua, old and near death, summoned all Israel and charged them to be faithful to the law of Moses and to avoid the remaining nations. He warned that if they intermarried with the Canaanites and served their gods, the LORD would bring disaster upon them.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass a long time after that the LORD had given rest unto Israel from all their enemies round about, that Joshua waxed old and stricken in age.</i> | A long time afterward, when the LORD had given rest to Israel from all their surrounding enemies, and Joshua was old and well advanced in years, |
| 2 | <i>And Joshua called for all Israel, and for their elders, and for their heads, and for their judges, and for their officers, and said unto them, I am old and stricken in age:</i> | Joshua summoned all Israel, its elders and heads, its judges and officers, and said to them, "I am now old and well advanced in years. |
| 3 | <i>And ye have seen all that the LORD your God hath done unto all these nations because of you; for the LORD your God is he that hath fought for you.</i> | you have seen all that the LORD Your God has done to all these nations for Your sake, for it is the LORD Your God Who has fought for You. |

- 4 *Behold, I have divided unto you by lot these nations that remain, to be an inheritance for your tribes, from Jordan, with all the nations that I have cut off, even unto the great sea westward.* I have allotted to You as an inheritance for Your tribes those nations that remain, along with all the nations that I have already cut off, from the Jordan to the Great Sea in the west.
- 5 *And the LORD your God, he shall expel them from before you, and drive them from out of your sight; and ye shall possess their land, as the LORD your God hath promised unto you.* The LORD Your God will push them back before You and drive them out of Your sight. And You shall possess their land, just as the LORD Your God promised You.
- 6 *Be ye therefore very courageous to keep and to do all that is written in the book of the law of Moses, that ye turn not aside therefrom to the right hand or to the left;* Therefore, be very strong to keep and to do all that is written in the Book of the Law of Moses, turning aside from it neither to the right hand nor to the left,
- 7 *That ye come not among these nations, these that remain among you; neither make mention of the name of their gods, nor cause to swear by them, neither serve them, nor bow yourselves unto them:* that you may not mix with these nations remaining among you or make mention of the names of their gods or swear by them or serve them or bow down to them,
- 8 *But cleave unto the LORD your God, as ye have done unto this day.* but You shall hold fast to the LORD Your God just as You have done to this day.
- 9 *For the LORD hath driven out from before you great nations and strong: but as for you, no man hath been able to stand before you unto this day.* For the LORD has driven out before You great and strong nations. And as for You, no man has been able to stand before You to this day.
- 10 *One man of you shall chase a thousand: for the LORD your God, he it is that fighteth for you, as he hath promised you.* One man of You puts to flight a thousand, since it is the LORD Your God Who fights for You, just as He promised You.

- 11 *Take good heed therefore unto yourselves, that ye love the LORD your God.* Be very careful, therefore, to love the LORD Your God.
- 12 *Else if ye do in any wise go back, and cleave unto the remnant of these nations, even these that remain among you, and shall make marriages with them, and go in unto them, and they to you:* For if You turn back and cling to the remnant of these nations remaining among You and make marriages with them, so that You associate with them and they with You,
- 13 *Know for a certainty that the LORD your God will no more drive out any of these nations from before you; but they shall be snares and traps unto you, and scourges in your sides, and thorns in your eyes, until ye perish from off this good land which the LORD your God hath given you.* know for certain that the LORD Your God will no longer drive out these nations before You. But they shall be a snare and a trap for You, a whip on Your sides and thorns in Your eyes, until You perish from off this good land that the LORD Your God has given You.
- 14 *And, behold, this day I am going the way of all the earth: and ye know in all your hearts and in all your souls, that not one thing hath failed of all the good things which the LORD your God spake concerning you; all are come to pass unto you, and not one thing hath failed thereof.* "And now I am about to go the way of all the earth, and You know in Your hearts and souls, all of You, that not one word has failed of all the good things that the LORD Your God promised concerning You. All have come to pass for You; not one of them has failed.
- 15 *Therefore it shall come to pass, that as all good things are come upon you, which the LORD your God promised you; so shall the LORD bring upon you all evil things, until he have destroyed you from off this good land which the LORD your God hath given you.* But just as all the good things that the LORD Your God promised concerning You have been fulfilled for You, so the LORD will bring upon You all the evil things, until He has destroyed You from off this good land that the LORD Your God has given You,

- 16 *When ye have transgressed the covenant of the LORD your God, which he commanded you, and have gone and served other gods, and bowed yourselves to them; then shall the anger of the LORD be kindled against you, and ye shall perish quickly from off the good land which he hath given unto you.*
- if You transgress the covenant of the LORD Your God, which He commanded You, and go and serve other gods and bow down to them. Then the anger of the LORD will be kindled against You, and You shall perish quickly from off the good land that He has given to You."

Words in this chapter:

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Jordan (JOR-dan) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Josh 13:1; Josh 21:44
v2 — Josh 24:1
v3 — Ex 14:14
v6 — Deut 28:14; Deut 5:32
v7 — Ex 23:13; Ps 16:4; Deut 7:2-3; Jer 5:7; Ex 23:33
v8 — Deut 10:20; Josh 22:5; Acts 11:23; Deut 13:4; Deut 11:22
v9 — Josh 1:5; Deut 11:23
v10 — Deut 32:30; Lev 26:8; Deut 3:22; Ex 14:14; Ps 35:1
v11 — Josh 22:5; Deut 6:5-12; Jude 1:20-21; Rom 8:28
v12 — Deut 7:3
v13 — Deut 7:16; Num 33:55; Ex 23:33
v14 — Luke 21:33; 1 Kgs 2:2; Lev 26:3-13; Eccl 9:10; Josh 21:43-45

Chapter 24

Joshua gathered Israel at Shechem and recounted God's faithfulness from Abraham through the conquest, then called the people to choose whom they would serve. The people vowed to serve the LORD; Joshua made a covenant, set up a stone witness, and died at the age of 110.

- 1 *And Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem, and called for the elders of Israel, and for their heads, and for their judges, and for their officers; and they presented themselves before God.* Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem and summoned the elders, the heads, the judges, and the officers of Israel. And they presented themselves before God.
- 2 *And Joshua said unto all the people, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Your fathers dwelt on the other side of the flood in old time, even Terah, the father of Abraham, and the father of Nachor: and they served other gods.* Joshua said to all the people, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, 'Long ago, Your fathers lived beyond the Euphrates, Terah, the father of Abraham and of Nahor. They served other gods.
- 3 *And I took your father Abraham from the other side of the flood, and led him throughout all the land of Canaan, and multiplied his seed, and gave him Isaac.* Then I took your father Abraham from beyond the River and led him through all the land of Canaan, and made his seed many. I gave him Isaac.
- 4 *And I gave unto Isaac Jacob and Esau: and I gave unto Esau mount Seir, to possess it; but Jacob and his children went down into Egypt.* to Isaac I gave Jacob and Esau. And I gave Esau the hill country of Seir to possess, but Jacob and his children went down to Egypt.
- 5 *I sent Moses also and Aaron, and I plagued Egypt, according to that which I did among them: and afterward I brought you out.* I sent Moses and Aaron. I plagued Egypt with what I did in the midst of it, and afterward I brought you out.
- 6 *And I brought your fathers out of Egypt: and ye came unto the sea; and the Egyptians pursued after your fathers with chariots and horsemen unto the Red sea.* Then I brought your fathers out of Egypt, and you came to the sea. And the Egyptians pursued your fathers with chariots and horsemen to the Red Sea.

- 7 *And when they cried unto the LORD, he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea upon them, and covered them; and your eyes have seen what I have done in Egypt: and ye dwelt in the wilderness a long season.* when they cried to the LORD, He put darkness between You and the Egyptians and made the sea come upon them and cover them. And Your eyes saw what I did in Egypt. And You lived in the wilderness a long time.
- 8 *And I brought you into the land of the Amorites, which dwelt on the other side Jordan; and they fought with you: and I gave them into your hand, that ye might possess their land; and I destroyed them from before you.* Then I brought You to the land of the Amorites, who lived on the other side of the Jordan. They fought with You. I gave them into Your hand, and You took possession of their land. I destroyed them before You.
- 9 *Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and warred against Israel, and sent and called Balaam the son of Beor to curse you:* Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and fought against Israel. And He sent and invited Balaam the son of Beor to curse You,
- 10 *But I would not hearken unto Balaam; therefore he blessed you still: so I delivered you out of his hand.* but I would not listen to Balaam. Indeed, He blessed You. So I delivered You out of His hand.
- 11 *And ye went over Jordan, and came unto Jericho: and the men of Jericho fought against you, the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Girgashites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites; and I delivered them into your hand.* you went over the Jordan and came to Jericho, and the leaders of Jericho fought against You, and also the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Girgashites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites. And I gave them into Your hand.
- 12 *And I sent the hornet before you, which drave them out from before you, even the two kings of the Amorites; but not with thy sword, nor with thy bow.* I sent the hornet before You, which drove them out before You, the two kings of the Amorites; it was not by Your sword or by Your bow.

- 13 *And I have given you a land for which ye did not labour, and cities which ye built not, and ye dwell in them; of the vineyards and oliveyards which ye planted not do ye eat.* I gave You a land on which You had not labored and cities that You had not built, and You dwell in them. You eat the fruit of vineyards and olive orchards that You did not plant.'
- 14 *Now therefore fear the LORD, and serve him in sincerity and in truth: and put away the gods which your fathers served on the other side of the flood, and in Egypt; and serve ye the LORD.* Now therefore fear the LORD and serve Him in sincerity and in faithfulness. Put away the gods that Your fathers served beyond the River and in Egypt, and serve the LORD.
- 15 *And if it seem evil unto you to serve the LORD, choose you this day whom ye will serve; whether the gods which your fathers served that were on the other side of the flood, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.* if it is evil in Your eyes to serve the LORD, choose this day whom You will serve, whether the gods Your fathers served in the region beyond the River, or the gods of the Amorites in whose land You dwell. But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD."
- 16 *And the people answered and said, God forbid that we should forsake the LORD, to serve other gods;* Then the people answered, "Far be it from us that we should forsake the LORD to serve other gods,
- 17 *For the LORD our God, he it is that brought us up and our fathers out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage, and which did those great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way wherein we went, and among all the people through whom we passed:* for it is the LORD our God Who brought us and our fathers up from the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery, and who did those great signs in our sight and preserved us in all the way that we went, and among all the peoples through whom we passed.
- 18 *And the LORD drave out from before us all the people, even the Amorites which dwelt in the land: therefore will we also serve the LORD; for he is our God.* the LORD drove out before us all the peoples, the Amorites who lived in the land. Therefore we also will serve the LORD, for He is our God."

- 19 *And Joshua said unto the people, Ye cannot serve the LORD: for he is an holy God; he is a jealous God; he will not forgive your transgressions nor your sins.* But Joshua said to the people, "You are not able to serve the LORD, for he is a holy God. He is a jealous God; he will not forgive your transgressions or your sins.
- 20 *If ye forsake the LORD, and serve strange gods, then he will turn and do you hurt, and consume you, after that he hath done you good.* If You forsake the LORD and serve foreign gods, then He will turn and do You harm and consume You, after having done You good."
- 21 *And the people said unto Joshua, Nay; but we will serve the LORD.* the people said to Joshua, "No, but we will serve the LORD."
- 22 *And Joshua said unto the people, Ye are witnesses against yourselves that ye have chosen you the LORD, to serve him. And they said, We are witnesses.* Then Joshua said to the people, "You are witnesses against yourselves that you have chosen the LORD, to serve him." And they said, "We are witnesses."
- 23 *Now therefore put away, said he, the strange gods which are among you, and incline your heart unto the LORD God of Israel.* He said, "Then put away the foreign gods that are among You, and incline Your heart to the LORD, the God of Israel."
- 24 *And the people said unto Joshua, The LORD our God will we serve, and his voice will we obey.* the people said to Joshua, "The LORD our God we will serve. His voice we will obey."
- 25 *So Joshua made a covenant with the people that day, and set them a statute and an ordinance in Shechem.* So Joshua made a covenant with the people that day, and put in place statutes and rules for them at Shechem.
- 26 *And Joshua wrote these words in the book of the law of God, and took a great stone, and set it up there under an oak, that was by the sanctuary of the LORD.* Joshua wrote these words in the Book of the Law of God. And He took a large stone and set it up there under the terebinth that was by the sanctuary of the LORD.

- 27 *And Joshua said unto all the people, Behold, this stone shall be a witness unto us; for it hath heard all the words of the LORD which he spake unto us: it shall be therefore a witness unto you, lest ye deny your God.* Joshua said to all the people, " this stone shall be a witness against us, for it has heard all the words of the LORD that He spoke to us. Therefore it shall be a witness against You, lest You deal falsely with Your God."
- 28 *So Joshua let the people depart, every man unto his inheritance.* So Joshua sent the people away, every man to his inheritance.
- 29 *And it came to pass after these things, that Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being an hundred and ten years old.* After these things Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being 110 years old.
- 30 *And they buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnathserah, which is in mount Ephraim, on the north side of the hill of Gaash.* they buried Him in His own inheritance at Timnath-serah, which is in the hill country of Ephraim, north of the mountain of Gaash.
- 31 *And Israel served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders that overlived Joshua, and which had known all the works of the LORD, that he had done for Israel.* Israel served the LORD all the days of Joshua. All the days of the elders who outlived Joshua and had known all the work that the LORD did for Israel.
- 32 *And the bones of Joseph, which the children of Israel brought up out of Egypt, buried they in Shechem, in a parcel of ground which Jacob bought of the sons of Hamor the father of Shechem for an hundred pieces of silver: and it became the inheritance of the children of Joseph.* As for the bones of Joseph, which the people of Israel brought up from Egypt, they buried them at Shechem, in the piece of land that Jacob bought from the sons of Hamor the father of Shechem for a hundred pieces of money. It became an inheritance of the descendants of Joseph.
- 33 *And Eleazar the son of Aaron died; and they buried him in a hill that pertained to Phinehas his son, which was given him in mount Ephraim.* Eleazar the son of Aaron died. They buried him in a hill that pertained to Phinehas his son, which had been given him in the hill country of Ephraim.

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Balak (*BAY-lak*) — King of Moab who hired Balaam to curse Israel — his name means 'devastator'; he feared Israel after their defeat of the Amorites.

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Josh 23:2; 1 Sam 10:19

v4 — Gen 36:8; Deut 2:5

v9 — Judg 11:25; Mic 6:5; Num 22:2

v10 — Num 24:5-10; Isa 54:17; Deut 23:5

v12 — Deut 7:20; Ex 23:28

v13 — Deut 6:10-12; Deut 8:7; Josh 21:45; Prov 13:22

v14 — 1 Sam 12:24; Deut 10:12; Gen 35:2; Josh 24:23; Ps 119:1

v15 — 1 Kgs 18:21; John 6:67-68; Ruth 1:15-16; Deut 29:18; Ezek 20:39

v19 — Ex 23:21; Isa 5:16; Ps 99:9; Ps 99:5; Lev 19:2

v20 — Heb 10:26-27; 1 Chr 28:9; Jer 17:13; Ezek 18:24; Acts 7:42

v27 — Luke 19:40; Josh 22:34

v32 — Gen 50:25; Gen 33:19; Ex 13:19

Judges

Author: Unknown — Jewish tradition credits Samuel, which fits the period and his role in closing the era of the judges.

Date written: Final form likely c. 1050–1000 BC, during the early monarchy.

Written to: Israel under the early kings, as an explanation of why the nation needed strong, God-appointed leadership.

Setting: Joshua is dead. The tribes have taken portions of Canaan but have not driven out all the inhabitants. Over roughly three hundred years, a recurring cycle of apostasy, oppression, repentance, and deliverance defines the nation's history.

Where this sits historically: c. 1380–1050 BC — the long judges era spanning roughly three centuries between the conquest and the rise of the monarchy, while Egypt's empire weakened and the Sea Peoples (Philistines) settled the coast.

Contemporaries: Egypt's late 18th, 19th, and 20th dynasties (Akhenaten through Ramesses III); Philistia, Moab, Midian, and Ammon as Israel's recurring oppressors. Ruth is set within this same period.

Big themes:

- The cycle of sin — Israel abandons God, suffers under foreign oppressors, cries out, is rescued by a judge, and then returns to sin once the judge dies; this pattern repeats twelve times
- "Every man did that which was right in his own eyes" — the book's haunting refrain (17:6, 21:25) diagnoses the disease beneath the cycle
- The judges — twelve deliverers ranging from the faithful (Deborah, Gideon early) to the deeply flawed (Samson); God uses broken instruments
- Canaanite influence — every failure traces back to tolerating what God commanded Israel to destroy
- The need for a king — not any king, but a king after God's own heart; Judges is the argument that Israel needs David

Key passages: Judg 2:16; 6:14; 11:29; 13:24; 21:25

How it fits: Judges picks up the moment Joshua ends and spans the gap to Samuel. The increasingly horrific events of the final chapters (the Levite's concubine, the near-destruction of Benjamin) show a nation in free fall. Ruth is set in this same period — a small counterpoint of grace. 1 Samuel opens with the answer: a prophet, then a king.

Chapter 1

After Joshua's death, Judah and Simeon led the initial campaigns against the Canaanites, defeating Adoni-bezek and capturing several cities. However, many tribes failed to drive out the inhabitants of their territories, allowing Canaanites to remain among them.

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| 1 | <i>Now after the death of Joshua it came to pass, that the children of Israel asked the LORD, saying, Who shall go up for us against the Canaanites first, to fight against them?</i> | After the death of Joshua, the people of Israel inquired of the LORD, "Who shall go up first for us against the Canaanites, to fight against them?" |
| 2 | <i>And the LORD said, Judah shall go up: behold, I have delivered the land into his hand.</i> | The LORD said, "Judah shall go up; I have given the land into His hand." |
| 3 | <i>And Judah said unto Simeon his brother, Come up with me into my lot, that we may fight against the Canaanites; and I likewise will go with thee into thy lot. So Simeon went with him.</i> | Judah said to Simeon His brother, "Come up with me into the territory allotted to me, that we may fight against the Canaanites. And I likewise will go with You into Your territory." So Simeon went with Him. |
| 4 | <i>And Judah went up; and the LORD delivered the Canaanites and the Perizzites into their hand: and they slew of them in Bezek ten thousand men.</i> | Then Judah went up and the LORD gave the Canaanites and the Perizzites into their hand. They defeated 10,000 of them at Bezek. |
| 5 | <i>And they found Adonibezek in Bezek: and they fought against him, and they slew the Canaanites and the Perizzites.</i> | They found Adoni-bezek at Bezek and fought against Him and defeated the Canaanites and the Perizzites. |
| 6 | <i>But Adonibezek fled; and they pursued after him, and caught him, and cut off his thumbs and his great toes.</i> | Adoni-bezek fled. But they pursued Him and caught Him and cut off His thumbs and His big toes. |

- 7 *And Adonibezek said, Threescore and ten kings, having their thumbs and their great toes cut off, gathered their meat under my table: as I have done, so God hath requited me. And they brought him to Jerusalem, and there he died.* Adoni-bezek said, "Seventy kings with their thumbs and their big toes cut off used to pick up scraps under my table. As I have done, so God has repaid me." And they brought Him to Jerusalem. He died there.
- 8 *Now the children of Judah had fought against Jerusalem, and had taken it, and smitten it with the edge of the sword, and set the city on fire.* the people of Judah fought against Jerusalem and captured it and struck it with the edge of the sword and set the city on fire.
- 9 *And afterward the children of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanites, that dwelt in the mountain, and in the south, and in the valley.* Afterward the people of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanites who lived in the hill country, in the south, and in the lowland.
- 10 *And Judah went against the Canaanites that dwelt in Hebron: (now the name of Hebron before was Kirjatharba:) and they slew Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmai.* Judah went against the Canaanites who lived in Hebron (now the name of Hebron was formerly Kirjatharba). They defeated Sheshai and Ahiman and Talmai.
- 11 *And from thence he went against the inhabitants of Debir: and the name of Debir before was Kirjathsepher:* From there they went against the inhabitants of Debir. The name of Debir was formerly Kirjathsepher.
- 12 *And Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjathsepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.* Caleb said, "Whoever strikes Kirjathsepher and captures it, I will give him Achsah my daughter as wife."
- 13 *And Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.* Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother, captured it. And he gave him Achsah his daughter as wife.

- 14 *And it came to pass, when she came to him, that she moved him to ask of her father a field: and she lighted from off her ass; and Caleb said unto her, What wilt thou?* When she came to him, she urged him to ask her father for a field. And she dismounted from her donkey, and Caleb said to her, "What do you want?"
- 15 *And she said unto him, Give me a blessing: for thou hast given me a south land; give me also springs of water. And Caleb gave her the upper springs and the nether springs.* She said to him, "Give me a blessing. Since you have set me in a south land, give me also springs of water." And Caleb gave her the upper springs and the lower springs.
- 16 *And the children of the Kenite, Moses' father in law, went up out of the city of palm trees with the children of Judah into the wilderness of Judah, which lieth in the south of Arad; and they went and dwelt among the people.* the descendants of the Kenite, Moses' father-in-law, went up with the people of Judah from the city of palms into the wilderness of Judah, which lies in the south of Arad. They went and settled with the people.
- 17 *And Judah went with Simeon his brother, and they slew the Canaanites that inhabited Zephath, and utterly destroyed it. And the name of the city was called Hormah.* Judah went with Simeon his brother. They defeated the Canaanites who inhabited Zephath and devoted it to destruction. So the name of the city was called Hormah.
- 18 *Also Judah took Gaza with the coast thereof, and Askelon with the coast thereof, and Ekron with the coast thereof.* Judah also captured Gaza with its territory, and Ashkelon with its territory, and Ekron with its territory.
- 19 *And the LORD was with Judah; and he drave out the inhabitants of the mountain; but could not drive out the inhabitants of the valley, because they had chariots of iron.* the LORD was with Judah. He took possession of the hill country. But He could not drive out the inhabitants of the plain because they had chariots of iron.
- 20 *And they gave Hebron unto Caleb, as Moses said: and he expelled thence the three sons of Anak.* Hebron was given to Caleb, as Moses had said. And he drove out from it the three sons of Anak.

- 21 *And the children of Benjamin did not drive out the Jebusites that inhabited Jerusalem; but the Jebusites dwell with the children of Benjamin in Jerusalem unto this day.* But the people of Benjamin did not drive out the Jebusites who lived in Jerusalem, so the Jebusites have lived with the people of Benjamin in Jerusalem to this day.
- 22 *And the house of Joseph, they also went up against Bethel: and the LORD was with them.* The house of Joseph also went up against Bethel. The LORD was with them.
- 23 *And the house of Joseph sent to descry Bethel. (Now the name of the city before was Luz.)* the house of Joseph scouted out Bethel. (Now the name of the city was formerly Luz.)
- 24 *And the spies saw a man come forth out of the city, and they said unto him, Shew us, we pray thee, the entrance into the city, and we will shew thee mercy.* the spies saw a man coming out of the city. They said to him, "Please show us the way into the city. We will deal kindly with you."
- 25 *And when he shewed them the entrance into the city, they smote the city with the edge of the sword; but they let go the man and all his family.* he showed them the way into the city. And they struck the city with the edge of the sword. But they let the man and all his family go.
- 26 *And the man went into the land of the Hittites, and built a city, and called the name thereof Luz: which is the name thereof unto this day.* the man went to the land of the Hittites and built a city and called its name Luz. That is its name to this day.
- 27 *Neither did Manasseh drive out the inhabitants of Bethshean and her towns, nor Taanach and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Dor and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Ibleam and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Megiddo and her towns: but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.* Manasseh did not drive out the inhabitants of Bethshean and its villages, or Taanach and its villages, or the inhabitants of Dor and its villages, or the inhabitants of Ibleam and its villages, or the inhabitants of Megiddo and its villages, for the Canaanites persisted in dwelling in that land.

- 28 *And it came to pass, when Israel was strong, that they put the Canaanites to tribute, and did not utterly drive them out.* When Israel grew strong, they put the Canaanites to forced labor, but did not drive them out completely.
- 29 *Neither did Ephraim drive out the Canaanites that dwelt in Gezer; but the Canaanites dwelt in Gezer among them.* Ephraim did not drive out the Canaanites who lived in Gezer, so the Canaanites lived in Gezer among them.
- 30 *Neither did Zebulun drive out the inhabitants of Kitron, nor the inhabitants of Nahalol; but the Canaanites dwelt among them, and became tributaries.* Zebulun did not drive out the inhabitants of Kitron, or the inhabitants of Nahalol, so the Canaanites lived among them, but became subject to forced labor.
- 31 *Neither did Asher drive out the inhabitants of Accho, nor the inhabitants of Zidon, nor of Ahlab, nor of Achzib, nor of Helbah, nor of Aphik, nor of Rehob:* Asher did not drive out the inhabitants of Acco, or the inhabitants of Sidon, or of Ahlab, or of Achzib, or of Helbah, or of Aphik, or of Rehob,
- 32 *But the Asherites dwelt among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land: for they did not drive them out.* so the Asherites lived among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land, for they did not drive them out.
- 33 *Neither did Naphtali drive out the inhabitants of Bethshemesh, nor the inhabitants of Bethanath; but he dwelt among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land: nevertheless the inhabitants of Bethshemesh and of Bethanath became tributaries unto them.* Naphtali did not drive out the inhabitants of Bethshemesh, or the inhabitants of Bethanath, so he lived among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land. Nevertheless the inhabitants of Bethshemesh and of Bethanath became subject to forced labor for them.
- 34 *And the Amorites forced the children of Dan into the mountain: for they would not suffer them to come down to the valley:* The Amorites pressed the people of Dan back into the hill country, for they did not allow them to come down to the plain.

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| <p>35 <i>But the Amorites would dwell in mount Heres in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim: yet the hand of the house of Joseph prevailed, so that they became tributaries.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And the coast of the Amorites was from the going up to Akrabbim, from the rock, and upward.</i></p> | <p>The Amorites persisted in dwelling in Mount Heres, in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim, but the hand of the house of Joseph rested heavily on them. They became subject to forced labor.</p> <p>the border of the Amorites ran from the ascent of Akrabbim, from Sela and upward.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Judg 20:18; Num 27:21; Judg 20:28

v2 — Rev 5:5

v7 — Rev 13:10; 1 Sam 15:33; Lev 24:19-21; Jas 2:13; Luke 6:37-38

v8 — Josh 15:63

v13 — Judg 3:9

v16 — Num 10:29-32; Judg 4:11; 1 Sam 15:6; Deut 34:3; Num 21:1

v17 — Num 21:3

v18 — Josh 11:22

v19 — Isa 41:10; Ps 60:12

v20 — Judg 1:10; Deut 1:36; Josh 15:13-14; Num 14:24

v21 — Josh 15:63

v29 — Josh 16:10; 1 Kgs 9:16

Chapter 2

The angel of the LORD rebuked Israel at Bochim for failing to tear down the altars of the Canaanites. The generation that knew Joshua died, and a new generation arose that did not know the LORD; Israel fell into a cycle of sin, oppression, and deliverance through judges.

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| 1 | <i>And an angel of the LORD came up from Gilgal to Bochim, and said, I made you to go up out of Egypt, and have brought you unto the land which I sware unto your fathers; and I said, I will never break my covenant with you.</i> | Now the angel of the LORD went up from Gilgal to Bochim. And He said, "I brought You up from Egypt and brought You into the land that I swore to give to Your fathers. I said, 'I will never break my covenant with You, |
| 2 | <i>And ye shall make no league with the inhabitants of this land; ye shall throw down their altars: but ye have not obeyed my voice: why have ye done this?</i> | you shall make no covenant with the inhabitants of this land; You shall break down their altars.' But You have not obeyed my voice. What is this You have done? |
| 3 | <i>Wherefore I also said, I will not drive them out from before you; but they shall be as thorns in your sides, and their gods shall be a snare unto you.</i> | So now I say, I will not drive them out before You. But they shall become thorns in Your sides, and their gods shall be a snare to You." |
| 4 | <i>And it came to pass, when the angel of the LORD spake these words unto all the children of Israel, that the people lifted up their voice, and wept.</i> | As soon as the angel of the LORD spoke these words to all the people of Israel, the people lifted up their voices and wept. |
| 5 | <i>And they called the name of that place Bochim: and they sacrificed there unto the LORD.</i> | they called the name of that place Bochim. And they sacrificed there to the LORD. |
| 6 | <i>And when Joshua had let the people go, the children of Israel went every man unto his inheritance to possess the land.</i> | When Joshua dismissed the people, the people of Israel went each to his inheritance to take possession of the land. |

- 7 *And the people served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders that outlived Joshua, who had seen all the great works of the LORD, that he did for Israel.* the people served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders who outlived Joshua, who had seen all the great work that the LORD had done for Israel.
- 8 *And Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being an hundred and ten years old.* Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died at the age of 110 years.
- 9 *And they buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnathserah, in the hill country of Ephraim, on the north of the hill Gaash.* they buried Him within the boundaries of His inheritance in Timnathserah, in the hill country of Ephraim, north of the mountain of Gaash.
- 10 *And also all that generation were gathered unto their fathers: and there arose another generation after them, which knew not the LORD, nor yet the works which he had done for Israel.* all that generation also were gathered to their fathers. And there arose another generation after them who did not know the LORD or the work that He had done for Israel.
- 11 *And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD, and served Baalim:* the people of Israel did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and served the Baals.
- 12 *And they forsook the LORD God of their fathers, which brought them out of the land of Egypt, and followed other gods, of the gods of the people that were round about them, and bowed themselves unto them, and provoked the LORD to anger.* they abandoned the LORD, the God of their fathers, who had brought them out of the land of Egypt. They went after other gods, from among the gods of the peoples who were around them, and bowed down to them. And they provoked the LORD to anger.
- 13 *And they forsook the LORD, and served Baal and Ashtaroth.* They abandoned the LORD and served the Baals and the Ashtaroth.

- 14 *And the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he delivered them into the hands of spoilers that spoiled them, and he sold them into the hands of their enemies round about, so that they could not any longer stand before their enemies.* So the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He gave them over to plunderers, who plundered them. And He sold them into the hand of their surrounding enemies, so that they could no longer withstand their enemies.
- 15 *Whithersoever they went out, the hand of the LORD was against them for evil, as the LORD had said, and as the LORD had sworn unto them: and they were greatly distressed.* Whenever they marched out, the hand of the LORD was against them for harm, as the LORD had warned, and as the LORD had sworn to them. And they were in terrible distress.
- 16 *Nevertheless the LORD raised up judges, which delivered them out of the hand of those that spoiled them.* Then the LORD raised up judges, who saved them out of the hand of those who plundered them.
- 17 *And yet they would not hearken unto their judges, but they went a whoring after other gods, and bowed themselves unto them: they turned quickly out of the way which their fathers walked in, obeying the commandments of the LORD; but they did not so.* Yet they did not listen to their judges, for they whored after other gods and bowed down to them. They soon turned aside from the way in which their fathers had walked, who had obeyed the commandments of the LORD. They did not do so.
- 18 *And when the LORD raised them up judges, then the LORD was with the judge, and delivered them out of the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge: for it repented the LORD because of their groanings by reason of them that oppressed them and vexed them.* Whenever the LORD raised up judges for them, the LORD was with the judge. He saved them from the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge. For the LORD was moved to pity by their groaning because of those who afflicted and oppressed them.

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| <p>19 <i>And it came to pass, when the judge was dead, that they returned, and corrupted themselves more than their fathers, in following other gods to serve them, and to bow down unto them; they ceased not from their own doings, nor from their stubborn way.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel; and he said, Because that this people hath transgressed my covenant which I commanded their fathers, and have not hearkened unto my voice;</i></p> <p>21 <i>I also will not henceforth drive out any from before them of the nations which Joshua left when he died:</i></p> <p>22 <i>That through them I may prove Israel, whether they will keep the way of the LORD to walk therein, as their fathers did keep it, or not.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Therefore the LORD left those nations, without driving them out hastily; neither delivered he them into the hand of Joshua.</i></p> | <p>But whenever the judge died, they turned back and were more corrupt than their fathers, going after other gods, serving them and bowing down to them. They did not drop any of their practices or their stubborn ways.</p> <p>So the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He said, "Because this people have transgressed my covenant that I commanded their fathers and have not obeyed my voice,</p> <p>I will no longer drive out before them any of the nations that Joshua left when he died,</p> <p>in order to test Israel by them, whether they will take care to walk in the way of the LORD as their fathers did, or not."</p> <p>So the LORD left those nations, not driving them out quickly. He did not give them into the hand of Joshua.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ex 20:2; Lev 26:42; Gen 17:7-8; Ex 23:20
v2 — Deut 7:2-4
v3 — Josh 23:13; Num 33:55; Ps 106:36; Deut 7:16; Ex 23:33
v10 — 1 Sam 2:12; Titus 1:16; Ex 5:2
v11 — Judg 4:1; Judg 10:6; Judg 3:7; Judg 6:1
v14 — 2 Kgs 17:20; Ps 106:40-42; Deut 32:30; Deut 31:17-18
v17 — Gal 1:6; Deut 9:12; Judg 2:7

v18 — Deut 32:36; Josh 1:5; Ex 2:24; 2 Kgs 13:22-23; Hos 11:8

v19 — Judg 8:33; Judg 4:1

v20 — Judg 2:14; Josh 23:16

v21 — Josh 23:13

v22 — Deut 8:2; Deut 8:16; Deut 13:3

Chapter 3

The nations left in Canaan to test Israel are named. Othniel delivered Israel from Cushan-rishathaim of Mesopotamia, Ehud assassinated Eglon king of Moab and led Israel to victory, and Shamgar struck down 600 Philistines with an ox goad.

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| <p>1 <i>Now these are the nations which the LORD left, to prove Israel by them, even as many of Israel as had not known all the wars of Canaan;</i></p> | <p>Now these are the nations that the LORD left, to test Israel by them, that is, all in Israel who had not experienced all the wars in Canaan.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Only that the generations of the children of Israel might know, to teach them war, at the least such as before knew nothing thereof;</i></p> | <p>It was only in order that the generations of the people of Israel might know war, to teach war to those who had not known it before.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Namely, five lords of the Philistines, and all the Canaanites, and the Sidonians, and the Hivites that dwelt in mount Lebanon, from mount Baalhermon unto the entering in of Hamath.</i></p> | <p>These are the nations: the five lords of the Philistines and all the Canaanites and the Sidonians and the Hivites who lived on Mount Lebanon, from Mount Baal-hermon unto the entering in of Hamath.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And they were to prove Israel by them, to know whether they would hearken unto the commandments of the LORD, which he commanded their fathers by the hand of Moses.</i></p> | <p>They were for the testing of Israel, to know whether Israel would obey the commandments of the LORD, which He commanded their fathers by the hand of Moses.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the children of Israel dwelt among the Canaanites, Hittites, and Amorites, and Perizzites, and Hivites, and Jebusites:</i></p> | <p>So the people of Israel lived among the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites.</p> |

- 6 *And they took their daughters to be their wives, and gave their daughters to their sons, and served their gods.* their daughters they took to themselves for wives. Their own daughters they gave to their sons. They served their gods.
- 7 *And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD, and forgot the LORD their God, and served Baalim and the groves.* the people of Israel did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. They forgot the LORD their God and served the Baals and the groves.
- 8 *Therefore the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of Chushanrishathaim king of Mesopotamia: and the children of Israel served Chushanrishathaim eight years.* Therefore the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He sold them into the hand of Chushanrishathaim king of Mesopotamia. And the people of Israel served Chushanrishathaim eight years.
- 9 *And when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised up a deliverer to the children of Israel, who delivered them, even Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother.* But when the people of Israel cried out to the LORD, the LORD raised up a deliverer for the people of Israel, who saved them, Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother.
- 10 *And the Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he judged Israel, and went out to war: and the LORD delivered Chushanrishathaim king of Mesopotamia into his hand; and his hand prevailed against Chushanrishathaim.* The Spirit of the LORD was upon Him. He judged Israel. He went out to war. The LORD gave Chushanrishathaim king of Mesopotamia into His hand. And His hand prevailed over Chushanrishathaim.
- 11 *And the land had rest forty years. And Othniel the son of Kenaz died.* So the land had rest forty years. Then Othniel the son of Kenaz died.
- 12 *And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel, because they had done evil in the sight of the LORD.* the people of Israel again did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. The LORD strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel, because they had done what was evil in the sight of the LORD.

- 13 *And he gathered unto him the children of Ammon and Amalek, and went and smote Israel, and possessed the city of palm trees.* He gathered to Himself the Ammonites and the Amalekites, and went and defeated Israel. And they took possession of the city of palms.
- 14 *So the children of Israel served Eglon the king of Moab eighteen years.* the people of Israel served Eglon the king of Moab eighteen years.
- 15 *But when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised them up a deliverer, Ehud the son of Gera, a Benjamite, a man lefthanded: and by him the children of Israel sent a present unto Eglon the king of Moab.* Then the people of Israel cried out to the LORD. The LORD raised up for them a deliverer, Ehud, the son of Gera, the Benjaminite, a left-handed man. The people of Israel sent tribute by him to Eglon the king of Moab.
- 16 *But Ehud made him a dagger which had two edges, of a cubit length; and he did gird it under his raiment upon his right thigh.* Ehud made for Himself a sword with two edges, a cubit in length. He bound it on His right thigh under His clothes.
- 17 *And he brought the present unto Eglon king of Moab: and Eglon was a very fat man.* he presented the tribute to Eglon king of Moab. Now Eglon was a very fat man.
- 18 *And when he had made an end to offer the present, he sent away the people that bare the present.* when Ehud had finished presenting the tribute, He sent away the people who carried the tribute.
- 19 *But he himself turned again from the quarries that were by Gilgal, and said, I have a secret errand unto thee, O king: who said, Keep silence. And all that stood by him went out from him.* But He Himself turned back at the idols near Gilgal and said, "I have a secret message for You, O king." And He commanded, "Silence." And all His attendants went out from His presence.
- 20 *And Ehud came unto him; and he was sitting in a summer parlour, which he had for himself alone. And Ehud said, I have a message from God unto thee. And he arose out of his seat.* Ehud came to Him as He was sitting alone in His cool roof chamber. And Ehud said, "I have a message from God for You." And He arose from His seat.

- 21 *And Ehud put forth his left hand, and took the dagger from his right thigh, and thrust it into his belly:* Ehud reached with His left hand, took the sword from His right thigh, and thrust it into His belly.
- 22 *And the haft also went in after the blade; and the fat closed upon the blade, so that he could not draw the dagger out of his belly; and the dirt came out.* the handle also went in after the blade, and the fat closed over the blade, for He did not pull the sword out of His belly. The dung came out.
- 23 *Then Ehud went forth through the porch, and shut the doors of the parlour upon him, and locked them.* Then Ehud went out into the porch and closed the doors of the roof chamber behind Him and locked them.
- 24 *When he was gone out, his servants came; and when they saw that, behold, the doors of the parlour were locked, they said, Surely he covereth his feet in his summer chamber.* When He had gone, the servants came, and when they saw that the doors of the roof chamber were locked, they thought, "He is relieving Himself in the cool chamber."
- 25 *And they tarried till they were ashamed: and, behold, he opened not the doors of the parlour: therefore they took a key, and opened them: and, behold, their lord was fallen down dead on the earth.* they waited till they were embarrassed. But when He still did not open the doors of the roof chamber, they took the key and opened them, and there lay their lord dead on the floor.
- 26 *And Ehud escaped while they tarried, and passed beyond the quarries, and escaped unto Seirath.* Ehud escaped while they delayed. He passed beyond the idols and escaped to Seirah.
- 27 *And it came to pass, when he was come, that he blew a trumpet in the mountain of Ephraim, and the children of Israel went down with him from the mount, and he before them.* When He arrived, He sounded the trumpet in the hill country of Ephraim. Then the people of Israel went down with him from the hill country. He was their leader.

- 28 *And he said unto them, Follow after me: for the LORD hath delivered your enemies the Moabites into your hand. And they went down after him, and took the fords of Jordan toward Moab, and suffered not a man to pass over.* he said to them, "Follow after me, for the LORD has given Your enemies the Moabites into Your hand." So they went down after Him and seized the fords of the Jordan against the Moabites and did not allow anyone to pass over.
- 29 *And they slew of Moab at that time about ten thousand men, all lusty, and all men of valour; and there escaped not a man.* they killed at that time about 10,000 of the Moabites, all strong, able-bodied men; not a man escaped.
- 30 *So Moab was subdued that day under the hand of Israel. And the land had rest fourscore years.* So Moab was subdued that day under the hand of Israel. And the land had rest for eighty years.
- 31 *And after him was Shamgar the son of Anath, which slew of the Philistines six hundred men with an ox goad: and he also delivered Israel.* After Him was Shamgar the son of Anath, who killed 600 of the Philistines with an oxgoad. He also saved Israel.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 2:21-22; Deut 7:22; Prov 17:3
 v6 — Ex 34:16; Deut 7:3-4
 v7 — Ex 34:13
 v8 — Judg 2:14
 v9 — Judg 3:15; Judg 1:13; Ps 22:5
 v10 — Judg 14:19; 1 Sam 11:6; Judg 14:6; Judg 13:25; Judg 11:29
 v13 — Judg 1:16
 v15 — Judg 3:9; Ps 78:34
 v24 — 1 Sam 24:3
 v27 — 1 Sam 13:3; Judg 6:34
 v28 — Judg 12:5
 v31 — Judg 5:6

Chapter 4

Israel was oppressed by Jabin king of Hazor and his commander Sisera, who had 900 iron chariots. The prophetess Deborah summoned Barak, and they defeated Sisera's army at the river Kishon; Jael killed Sisera by driving a tent peg through his temple.

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| 1 | <i>And the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the LORD, when Ehud was dead.</i> | the people of Israel again did what was evil in the sight of the LORD after Ehud died. |
| 2 | <i>And the LORD sold them into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, that reigned in Hazor; the captain of whose host was Sisera, which dwelt in Harosheth of the Gentiles.</i> | the LORD sold them into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, who reigned in Hazor. The commander of His army was Sisera, who lived in Harosheth of the Gentiles. |
| 3 | <i>And the children of Israel cried unto the LORD: for he had nine hundred chariots of iron; and twenty years he mightily oppressed the children of Israel.</i> | Then the people of Israel cried out to the LORD for help, for He had 900 chariots of iron and He oppressed the people of Israel cruelly for twenty years. |
| 4 | <i>And Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lapidoth, she judged Israel at that time.</i> | Now Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lapidoth, was judging Israel at that time. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Deborah** (DEB-or-ah) — "bee" — A prophetess and the only female judge of Israel. She held court under a palm tree in Ephraim and summoned Barak to lead Israel against Sisera's Canaanite army. Her victory song in chapter 5 is one of the oldest poems in Scripture.

- 5 *And she dwelt under the palm tree of Deborah between Ramah and Bethel in mount Ephraim: and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment.* She used to sit under the palm of Deborah between Ramah and Bethel in the hill country of Ephraim, and the people of Israel came up to her for judgment.
- 6 *And she sent and called Barak the son of Abinoam out of Kedeshnaphtali, and said unto him, Hath not the LORD God of Israel commanded, saying, Go and draw toward mount Tabor, and take with thee ten thousand men of the children of Naphtali and of the children of Zebulun?* She sent and summoned Barak the son of Abinoam from Kedesh-naphtali and said to Him, "Has not the LORD, the God of Israel, commanded You, 'Go, gather Your men at Mount Tabor, taking 10,000 from the people of Naphtali and the people of Zebulun.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Barak** (BAIR-ak) — "lightning" — Son of Abinoam from Kedesh in Naphtali. He led 10,000 men against Sisera's army at Deborah's command but refused to go without her. Listed among the heroes of faith in Hebrews 11:32.

- 7 *And I will draw unto thee to the river Kishon Sisera, the captain of Jabin's army, with his chariots and his multitude; and I will deliver him into thine hand.* I will draw out Sisera, the general of Jabin's army, to meet You by the river Kishon with his chariots and His troops. I will give Him into Your hand?"
- 8 *And Barak said unto her, If thou wilt go with me, then I will go: but if thou wilt not go with me, then I will not go.* Barak said to her, "If You will go with me, I will go, but if You will not go with me, I will not go."
- 9 *And she said, I will surely go with thee: notwithstanding the journey that thou takest shall not be for thine honour; for the LORD shall sell Sisera into the hand of a woman. And Deborah arose, and went with Barak to Kedesh.* she said, "I will surely go with You. Nevertheless, the road on which You are going will not lead to Your glory, for the LORD will sell Sisera into the hand of a woman." Then Deborah arose and went with Barak to Kedesh.

- 10 *And Barak called Zebulun and Naphtali to Kedesh; and he went up with ten thousand men at his feet: and Deborah went up with him.* Barak called out Zebulun and Naphtali to Kedesh. And 10,000 men went up at His heels, and Deborah went up with Him.
- 11 *Now Heber the Kenite, which was of the children of Hobab the father in law of Moses, had severed himself from the Kenites, and pitched his tent unto the plain of Zaanaïm, which is by Kedesh.* Now Heber the Kenite had separated from the Kenites, the descendants of Hobab the father-in-law of Moses, and had pitched his tent unto the plain of Zaanaïm, which is near Kedesh.
- 12 *And they shewed Sisera that Barak the son of Abinoam was gone up to mount Tabor.* When Sisera was told that Barak the son of Abinoam had gone up to Mount Tabor,
- 13 *And Sisera gathered together all his chariots, even nine hundred chariots of iron, and all the people that were with him, from Harosheth of the Gentiles unto the river of Kishon.* Sisera called out all his chariots, 900 chariots of iron. All the men who were with him, from Harosheth of the Gentiles to the river Kishon.
- 14 *And Deborah said unto Barak, Up; for this is the day in which the LORD hath delivered Sisera into thine hand: is not the LORD gone out before thee? So Barak went down from mount Tabor, and ten thousand men after him.* Deborah said to Barak, "Up! For this is the day in which the LORD has given Sisera into Your hand. Does not the LORD go out before You?" So Barak went down from Mount Tabor with 10,000 men following Him.
- 15 *And the LORD discomfited Sisera, and all his chariots, and all his host, with the edge of the sword before Barak; so that Sisera lighted down off his chariot, and fled away on his feet.* the LORD routed Sisera and all his chariots and all His army before Barak by the edge of the sword. And Sisera got down from his chariot and fled away on foot.
- 16 *But Barak pursued after the chariots, and after the host, unto Harosheth of the Gentiles: and all the host of Sisera fell upon the edge of the sword; and there was not a man left.* Barak pursued the chariots and the army to Harosheth of the Gentiles. All the army of Sisera fell by the edge of the sword; not a man was left.

- 17 *Howbeit Sisera fled away on his feet to the tent of Jael the wife of Heber the Kenite: for there was peace between Jabin the king of Hazor and the house of Heber the Kenite.* But Sisera fled away on foot to the tent of Jael, the wife of Heber the Kenite, for there was peace between Jabin the king of Hazor and the house of Heber the Kenite.
- 18 *And Jael went out to meet Sisera, and said unto him, Turn in, my lord, turn in to me; fear not. And when he had turned in unto her into the tent, she covered him with a mantle.* Jael came out to meet Sisera and said to him, "Turn aside, my lord; turn aside to me; do not be afraid." So he turned aside to her into the tent. She covered him with a blanket.
- 19 *And he said unto her, Give me, I pray thee, a little water to drink; for I am thirsty. And she opened a bottle of milk, and gave him drink, and covered him.* he said to her, "Please give me a little water to drink, for I am thirsty." So she opened a skin of milk and gave him a drink and covered him.
- 20 *Again he said unto her, Stand in the door of the tent, and it shall be, when any man doth come and enquire of thee, and say, Is there any man here? that thou shalt say, No.* he said to her, "Stand at the opening of the tent, and if any man comes and asks you, 'Is anyone here?' say, 'No.' "
- 21 *Then Jael Heber's wife took a nail of the tent, and took an hammer in her hand, and went softly unto him, and smote the nail into his temples, and fastened it into the ground: for he was fast asleep and weary. So he died.* But Jael the wife of Heber took a tent peg, and took a hammer in her hand. Then she went softly to him and drove the peg into his temple until it went down into the ground while he was lying fast asleep from weariness. So he died.
- 22 *And, behold, as Barak pursued Sisera, Jael came out to meet him, and said unto him, Come, and I will shew thee the man whom thou seekest. And when he came into her tent, behold, Sisera lay dead, and the nail was in his temples.* as Barak was pursuing Sisera, Jael went out to meet him and said to him, "Come. I will show you the man whom you are seeking." So he went in to her tent, and there lay Sisera dead, with the tent peg in his temple.

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| 23 | <i>So God subdued on that day Jabin the king of Canaan before the children of Israel.</i> | So on that day God subdued Jabin the king of Canaan before the people of Israel. |
| 24 | <i>And the hand of the children of Israel prospered, and prevailed against Jabin the king of Canaan, until they had destroyed Jabin king of Canaan.</i> | the hand of the people of Israel pressed harder and harder against Jabin the king of Canaan, until they destroyed Jabin king of Canaan. |

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

Deborah (*DEB-oh-rah*) — A prophetess and judge of Israel — led Israel to victory over Jabin's army through Barak; her name means 'bee.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 5:3

v2 — Judg 4:16; Judg 4:13; Josh 11:1

v3 — Judg 1:19

v4 — Ex 15:20

v6 — Acts 13:47; Judg 8:18; Heb 11:32

v9 — 1 Sam 2:30

v10 — Judg 5:18

v11 — Josh 19:33; Judg 1:16; Num 10:29

v14 — 2 Sam 5:24; Deut 9:3; Isa 52:12; Ps 68:7-8

v15 — Josh 10:10

Chapter 5

Deborah and Barak sang a victory song celebrating the LORD's triumph over Sisera and his forces. The song praised the willing tribes, recounted the battle at the river Kishon, and honored Jael for killing Sisera.

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| 1 <i>Then sang Deborah and Barak the son of Abinoam on that day, saying,</i> | Then sang Deborah and Barak the son of Abinoam on that day: |
| 2 <i>Praise ye the LORD for the avenging of Israel, when the people willingly offered themselves.</i> | "That the leaders took the lead in Israel, that the people offered themselves willingly, bless the LORD! |
| 3 <i>Hear, O ye kings; give ear, O ye princes; I, even I, will sing unto the LORD; I will sing praise to the LORD God of Israel.</i> | Hear, O kings; give ear, O princes; to the LORD I will sing; I will make melody to the LORD, the God of Israel. |
| 4 <i>LORD, when thou wentest out of Seir, when thou marchedst out of the field of Edom, the earth trembled, and the heavens dropped, the clouds also dropped water.</i> | LORD, when You went out from Seir, when You marched from the region of Edom, the earth trembled and the heavens dropped, yes, the clouds dropped water. |
| 5 <i>The mountains melted from before the LORD, even that Sinai from before the LORD God of Israel.</i> | The mountains quaked before the LORD, even Sinai before the LORD, the God of Israel. |
| 6 <i>In the days of Shamgar the son of Anath, in the days of Jael, the highways were unoccupied, and the travellers walked through byways.</i> | In the days of Shamgar, son of Anath, in the days of Jael, the highways were abandoned, and travelers kept to the byways. |
| 7 <i>The inhabitants of the villages ceased, they ceased in Israel, until that I Deborah arose, that I arose a mother in Israel.</i> | The villagers ceased in Israel; they ceased to be until I arose; I, Deborah, arose as a mother in Israel. |
| 8 <i>They chose new gods; then was war in the gates: was there a shield or spear seen among forty thousand in Israel?</i> | When new gods were chosen, then war was in the gates. Was shield or spear to be seen among forty thousand in Israel? |
| 9 <i>My heart is toward the governors of Israel, that offered themselves willingly among the people. Bless ye the LORD.</i> | My heart goes out to the commanders of Israel who offered themselves willingly among the people. Bless the LORD. |

- 10 *Speak, ye that ride on white asses, ye that sit in judgment, and walk by the way.* Tell of it, You who ride on tawny donkeys, You who sit on rich carpets and You who walk by the way.
- 11 *They that are delivered from the noise of archers in the places of drawing water, there shall they rehearse the righteous acts of the LORD, even the righteous acts toward the inhabitants of his villages in Israel: then shall the people of the LORD go down to the gates.* To the sound of musicians at the watering places, there they repeat the righteous triumphs of the LORD, the righteous triumphs of his villagers in Israel. Then down to the gates marched the people of the LORD.
- 12 *Awake, awake, Deborah: awake, awake, utter a song: arise, Barak, and lead thy captivity captive, thou son of Abinoam.* Awake, awake, Deborah! Awake, awake, break out in a song! Arise, Barak, lead away Your captives, O son of Abinoam.
- 13 *Then he made him that remaineth have dominion over the nobles among the people: the LORD made me have dominion over the mighty.* Then down marched the remnant of the noble; the people of the LORD marched down for me against the mighty.
- 14 *Out of Ephraim was there a root of them against Amalek; after thee, Benjamin, among thy people; out of Machir came down governors, and out of Zebulun they that handle the pen of the writer.* From Ephraim their root they marched down into the valley, following You, Benjamin, with Your kinsmen; from Machir marched down the commanders, and from Zebulun those who bear the lieutenant's staff;
- 15 *And the princes of Issachar were with Deborah; even Issachar, and also Barak: he was sent on foot into the valley. For the divisions of Reuben there were great thoughts of heart.* the princes of Issachar came with Deborah, and Issachar faithful to Barak; into the valley they rushed at His heels. Among the clans of Reuben there were great searchings of heart.
- 16 *Why abodest thou among the sheepfolds, to hear the bleatings of the flocks? For the divisions of Reuben there were great searchings of heart.* Why did You sit still among the sheepfolds, to hear the whistling for the flocks? Among the clans of Reuben there were great searchings of heart.

- 17 *Gilead abode beyond Jordan: and why did Dan remain in ships? Asher continued on the sea shore, and abode in his breaches.* Gilead stayed beyond the Jordan. Dan, why did He stay with the ships? Asher sat still at the coast of the sea, staying by His landings.
- 18 *Zebulun and Naphtali were a people that jeopardized their lives unto the death in the high places of the field.* Zebulun is a people who risked their lives to the death; Naphtali, too, on the heights of the field.
- 19 *The kings came and fought, then fought the kings of Canaan in Taanach by the waters of Megiddo; they took no gain of money.* The kings came, they fought; then fought the kings of Canaan, at Taanach, by the waters of Megiddo; they got no spoils of silver.
- 20 *They fought from heaven; the stars in their courses fought against Sisera.* From heaven the stars fought, from their courses they fought against Sisera.
- 21 *The river of Kishon swept them away, that ancient river, the river Kishon. O my soul, thou hast trodden down strength.* The torrent Kishon swept them away, the ancient torrent, the torrent Kishon. you have trodden down strength.
- 22 *Then were the horsehoofs broken by the means of the pransings, the pransings of their mighty ones.* Then loud beat the horses' hoofs with the galloping, galloping of His steeds.
- 23 *Curse ye Meroz, said the angel of the LORD, curse ye bitterly the inhabitants thereof; because they came not to the help of the LORD, to the help of the LORD against the mighty.* Curse Meroz, says the angel of the LORD, curse its inhabitants thoroughly, because they did not come to the help of the LORD, to the help of the LORD against the mighty.
- 24 *Blessed above women shall Jael the wife of Heber the Kenite be, blessed shall she be above women in the tent.* Most blessed of women be Jael, the wife of Heber the Kenite, of tent-dwelling women most blessed.
- 25 *He asked water, and she gave him milk; she brought forth butter in a lordly dish.* He asked for water and she gave Him milk; she brought Him curds in a noble's bowl.

- 26 *She put her hand to the nail, and her right hand to the workmen's hammer; and with the hammer she smote Sisera, she smote off his head, when she had pierced and stricken through his temples.* She sent her hand to the tent peg and her right hand to the workmen's mallet; she struck Sisera; she crushed His head; she shattered and pierced His temple.
- 27 *At her feet he bowed, he fell, he lay down: at her feet he bowed, he fell: where he bowed, there he fell down dead.* Between her feet He sank, He fell, He lay still; between her feet He sank, He fell; where He sank, there He fell—dead.
- 28 *The mother of Sisera looked out at a window, and cried through the lattice, Why is his chariot so long in coming? why tarry the wheels of his chariots?* Out of the window she peered, the mother of Sisera wailed through the lattice: 'Why is his chariot so long in coming? Why wait the hoofbeats of his chariots?'
- 29 *Her wise ladies answered her, yea, she returned answer to herself,* Her wisest princesses answer, indeed, she answers herself,
- 30 *Have they not sped? have they not divided the prey; to every man a damsel or two; to Sisera a prey of divers colours, a prey of divers colours of needlework, of divers colours of needlework on both sides, meet for the necks of them that take the spoil?* 'Have they not found and divided the spoil?—A damsel or two to every man; spoil of dyed materials for Sisera, spoil of dyed materials embroidered, two pieces of dyed work embroidered for the neck as spoil?'
- 31 *So let all thine enemies perish, O LORD: but let them that love him be as the sun when he goeth forth in his might. And the land had rest forty years.* So may all Your enemies perish, O LORD! But Your friends be like the sun as He rises in His might." And the land had rest for forty years.

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ex 15:1

v4 — Deut 33:2

v5 — Ex 19:18; Ps 97:5

v6 — Isa 33:8; Judg 3:31

v9 — Judg 5:2

v11 — Mic 6:5; Judg 5:8; 1 Sam 12:7; Deut 22:24; Lam 5:9

v12 — Eph 4:8; Ps 68:18; Ps 57:8; 2 Tim 2:26

v18 — Judg 4:10

v19 — Judg 5:30; Judg 1:27

v20 — Josh 10:11; 1 Sam 7:10; Judg 4:15; Ps 77:17-18

v24 — Luke 1:42; Luke 1:28; Judg 4:17; Gen 14:19; Prov 31:31

v31 — Ps 37:6; 2 Sam 23:4; Ps 19:4-5; 1 Cor 8:3; Ps 91:14

Chapter 6

Israel was impoverished by seven years of Midianite raids, and the angel of the LORD appeared to Gideon at the winepress, calling him to deliver Israel. Gideon tore down his father's altar to Baal and twice tested God with a fleece.

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| <p>¹ <i>And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD delivered them into the hand of Midian seven years.</i></p> | <p>The people of Israel did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. The LORD gave them into the hand of Midian seven years.</p> |
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- 2 *And the hand of Midian prevailed against Israel: and because of the Midianites the children of Israel made them the dens which are in the mountains, and caves, and strong holds.* the hand of Midian overpowered Israel, and because of Midian the people of Israel made for themselves the dens that are in the mountains and the caves and the strongholds.
- 3 *And so it was, when Israel had sown, that the Midianites came up, and the Amalekites, and the children of the east, even they came up against them;* For whenever Israel planted crops, the Midianites and the Amalekites and the people of the East would come up against them.
- 4 *And they encamped against them, and destroyed the increase of the earth, till thou come unto Gaza, and left no sustenance for Israel, neither sheep, nor ox, nor ass.* They would encamp against them and devour the produce of the land, as far as Gaza, and leave no sustenance in Israel and no sheep or ox or donkey.
- 5 *For they came up with their cattle and their tents, and they came as grasshoppers for multitude; for both they and their camels were without number: and they entered into the land to destroy it.* For they would come up with their livestock and their tents; they would come like locusts in number—both they and their camels could not be counted—so that they laid waste the land as they came in.
- 6 *And Israel was greatly impoverished because of the Midianites; and the children of Israel cried unto the LORD.* Israel was brought very low because of Midian. And the people of Israel cried out for help to the LORD.
- 7 *And it came to pass, when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD because of the Midianites,* When the people of Israel cried out to the LORD on account of the Midianites,
- 8 *That the LORD sent a prophet unto the children of Israel, which said unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I brought you up from Egypt, and brought you forth out of the house of bondage;* the LORD sent a prophet to the people of Israel. And he said to them, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: I led You up from Egypt and brought You out of the house of slavery.

- 9 *And I delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all that oppressed you, and drave them out from before you, and gave you their land;* I delivered You from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all who oppressed You, and drove them out before You and gave You their land.
- 10 *And I said unto you, I am the LORD your God; fear not the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but ye have not obeyed my voice.* I said to You, 'I am the LORD Your God; You shall not fear the gods of the Amorites in whose land You dwell.' But You have not obeyed my voice."
- 11 *And there came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak which was in Ophrah, that pertained unto Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon threshed wheat by the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites.* Now the angel of the LORD came and sat under the terebinth at Ophrah, which belonged to Joash the Abiezrite, while his son Gideon was beating out wheat in the winepress to hide it from the Midianites.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gideon** (GID-ee-un) — "feller, great warrior" — Son of Joash the Abiezrite, called by the angel of the LORD while threshing wheat in hiding. God reduced his army from 32,000 to 300 to prove that victory belongs to the LORD. Also called Jerubbaal ("let Baal contend").

- 12 *And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him, and said unto him, The LORD is with thee, thou mighty man of valour.* the angel of the LORD appeared to Him and said to Him, "The LORD is with You, O mighty man of valor."
- 13 *And Gideon said unto him, Oh my Lord, if the LORD be with us, why then is all this befallen us? and where be all his miracles which our fathers told us of, saying, Did not the LORD bring us up from Egypt? but now the LORD hath forsaken us, and delivered us into the hands of the Midianites.* Gideon said to him, "Please, my lord, if the LORD is with us, why then has all this happened to us? And where are all His wonderful deeds that our fathers recounted to us, saying, 'Did not the LORD bring us up from Egypt?' But now the LORD has forsaken us and given us into the hand of Midian."

- 14 *And the LORD looked upon him, and said, Go in this thy might, and thou shalt save Israel from the hand of the Midianites: have not I sent thee?* the LORD turned to Him and said, "Go in this might of Yours and save Israel from the hand of Midian; do not I send You?"
- 15 *And he said unto him, Oh my Lord, wherewith shall I save Israel? behold, my family is poor in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house.* he said to him, "Please, Lord, how can I save Israel? my clan is the weakest in Manasseh. I am the least in my father's house."
- 16 *And the LORD said unto him, Surely I will be with thee, and thou shalt smite the Midianites as one man.* the LORD said to Him, "But I will be with You, and You shall strike the Midianites as one man."
- 17 *And he said unto him, If now I have found grace in thy sight, then shew me a sign that thou talkest with me.* he said to Him, "If now I have found favor in Your eyes, then show me a sign that it is You who speak with me."
- 18 *Depart not hence, I pray thee, until I come unto thee, and bring forth my present, and set it before thee. And he said, I will tarry until thou come again.* Please do not depart from here until I come to You and bring out my present and set it before You." And He said, "I will stay till You return."
- 19 *And Gideon went in, and made ready a kid, and unleavened cakes of an ephah of flour: the flesh he put in a basket, and he put the broth in a pot, and brought it out unto him under the oak, and presented it.* So Gideon went into his house and prepared a young goat and unleavened cakes from an ephah of flour. The meat he put in a basket, and the broth he put in a pot, and brought them to him under the terebinth and presented them.
- 20 *And the angel of God said unto him, Take the flesh and the unleavened cakes, and lay them upon this rock, and pour out the broth. And he did so.* the angel of God said to Him, "Take the meat and the unleavened cakes, and put them on this rock, and pour the broth over them." And He did so.

- 21 *Then the angel of the LORD put forth the end of the staff that was in his hand, and touched the flesh and the unleavened cakes; and there rose up fire out of the rock, and consumed the flesh and the unleavened cakes. Then the angel of the LORD departed out of his sight.* Then the angel of the LORD reached out the tip of the staff that was in His hand and touched the meat and the unleavened cakes. And fire sprang up from the rock and consumed the meat and the unleavened cakes. And the angel of the LORD vanished from His sight.
- 22 *And when Gideon perceived that he was an angel of the LORD, Gideon said, Alas, O Lord GOD! for because I have seen an angel of the LORD face to face.* Then Gideon saw that he was the angel of the LORD. And Gideon said, "Alas, O Lord GOD! For now I have seen the angel of the LORD face to face."
- 23 *And the LORD said unto him, Peace be unto thee; fear not: thou shalt not die.* But the LORD said to Him, "Peace be to You. Do not fear; You shall not die."
- 24 *Then Gideon built an altar there unto the LORD, and called it Jehovahshalom: unto this day it is yet in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.* Then Gideon built an altar there to the LORD and called it Jehovahshalom: unto this day it is yet in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.
- 25 *And it came to pass the same night, that the LORD said unto him, Take thy father's young bullock, even the second bullock of seven years old, and throw down the altar of Baal that thy father hath, and cut down the grove that is by it:* That night the LORD said to Him, "Take Your father's bull, and the second bull seven years old, and pull down the altar of Baal that Your father has, and cut down the grove that is by it
- 26 *And build an altar unto the LORD thy God upon the top of this rock, in the ordered place, and take the second bullock, and offer a burnt sacrifice with the wood of the grove which thou shalt cut down.* build an altar to the LORD Your God on the top of the stronghold here, with stones laid in due order. Then take the second bull and offer it as a burnt offering with the wood of the grove which you shall cut down."

- 27 *Then Gideon took ten men of his servants, and did as the LORD had said unto him: and so it was, because he feared his father's household, and the men of the city, that he could not do it by day, that he did it by night.* So Gideon took ten men of his servants and did as the LORD had told Him. But because He was too afraid of His family and the men of the town to do it by day, He did it by night.
- 28 *And when the men of the city arose early in the morning, behold, the altar of Baal was cast down, and the grove was cut down that was by it, and the second bullock was offered upon the altar that was built.* When the men of the town rose early in the morning, the altar of Baal was broken down, and the grove beside it was cut down, and the second bull was offered on the altar that had been built.
- 29 *And they said one to another, Who hath done this thing? And when they enquired and asked, they said, Gideon the son of Joash hath done this thing.* they said to one another, "Who has done this thing?" And after they had searched and inquired, they said, "Gideon the son of Joash has done this thing."
- 30 *Then the men of the city said unto Joash, Bring out thy son, that he may die: because he hath cast down the altar of Baal, and because he hath cut down the grove that was by it.* Then the men of the town said to Joash, "Bring out your son, that he may die, for he has broken down the altar of Baal and cut down the grove that was by it."
- 31 *And Joash said unto all that stood against him, Will ye plead for Baal? will ye save him? he that will plead for him, let him be put to death whilst it is yet morning: if he be a god, let him plead for himself, because one hath cast down his altar.* But Joash said to all who stood against him, "Will you contend for Baal? Or will you save him? Whoever contends for him shall be put to death by morning. If he is a god, let Him contend for himself, because His altar has been broken down."
- 32 *Therefore on that day he called him Jerubbaal, saying, Let Baal plead against him, because he hath thrown down his altar.* Therefore on that day Gideon was called Jerubbaal, that is to say, "Let Baal contend against him," because he broke down his altar.

- 33 *Then all the Midianites and the Amalekites and the children of the east were gathered together, and went over, and pitched in the valley of Jezreel.* Now all the Midianites and the Amalekites and the people of the East came together. They crossed the Jordan and encamped in the Valley of Jezreel.
- 34 *But the Spirit of the LORD came upon Gideon, and he blew a trumpet; and Abiezer was gathered after him.* But the Spirit of the LORD clothed Gideon. He sounded the trumpet, and the Abiezrites were called out to follow Him.
- 35 *And he sent messengers throughout all Manasseh; who also was gathered after him: and he sent messengers unto Asher, and unto Zebulun, and unto Naphtali; and they came up to meet them.* he sent messengers throughout all Manasseh. They too were called out to follow him. And he sent messengers to Asher, Zebulun, and Naphtali. They went up to meet them.
- 36 *And Gideon said unto God, If thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said,* Then Gideon said to God, "If you will save Israel by my hand, as you have said,
- 37 *Behold, I will put a fleece of wool in the floor; and if the dew be on the fleece only, and it be dry upon all the earth beside, then shall I know that thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said.* I am laying a fleece of wool on the threshing floor. If there is dew on the fleece alone, and it is dry on all the ground, then I shall know that you will save Israel by my hand, as you have said."
- 38 *And it was so: for he rose up early on the morrow, and thrust the fleece together, and wringed the dew out of the fleece, a bowl full of water.* it was so. When he rose early next morning and squeezed the fleece, he wrung enough dew from the fleece to fill a bowl with water.
- 39 *And Gideon said unto God, Let not thine anger be hot against me, and I will speak but this once: let me prove, I pray thee, but this once with the fleece; let it now be dry only upon the fleece, and upon all the ground let there be dew.* Then Gideon said to God, "Let not your anger burn against me; let me speak just once more. Please let me test just once more with the fleece. Please let it be dry on the fleece only, and on all the ground let there be dew."

- 40 *And God did so that night: for it was dry upon the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.* God did so that night. It was dry on the fleece only, and on all the ground there was dew.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Midianites (*MID-ee-an-ytes*) — A nomadic people descended from Abraham's son Midian — Moses fled to Midian; the Midianites oppressed Israel for seven years before Gideon defeated them.

Gideon (*GID-ee-on*) — A judge who defeated the Midianites with 300 men — God reduced his army to show the victory was His alone; his name means 'mighty warrior.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Jehovahshalom (*jeh-HO-vah-SHAH-lom*) — Hebrew name meaning 'The LORD is peace' — the name Gideon gave to the altar after God reassured him.

Cross-References:

- v6** — Judg 3:9; Jer 5:17; Ps 106:43-44; Ps 50:15
- v8** — Ezek 20:5-32; Ps 136:10-16; Isa 63:9-14
- v11** — Josh 17:2; Heb 11:32; Judg 13:3
- v12** — Josh 1:5; Luke 1:28; Judg 2:18; Josh 1:9; Judg 13:3
- v13** — Ps 77:7-9; 2 Chr 15:2; Isa 59:1-2; Ps 44:1; Ps 89:49
- v14** — Josh 1:5-9; Heb 11:34; 1 Sam 12:11; Judg 4:6; 1 Chr 14:9-10
- v15** — Ex 3:11; 1 Sam 9:21; Ex 4:10; Jer 1:6; Eph 3:8
- v16** — Josh 1:5; Acts 11:21; Ex 3:12; Mark 16:20
- v17** — Ps 86:17; Ex 33:13; Isa 7:11; Ex 33:16; Isa 38:7-8
- v24** — Gen 22:14; Ex 17:15; Ezek 48:35; Judg 8:32; Jer 33:16
- v25** — Ex 34:13; Judg 3:7; 2 Cor 6:15-17; Acts 5:29; Matt 10:37
- v34** — 2 Chr 24:20; Rom 13:14; Judg 3:27; 1 Chr 12:18; Judg 3:10

Chapter 7

God reduced Gideon's army from 32,000 to 300 men by the test at the water. The 300 surrounded the Midianite camp at night with torches, jars, and trumpets; the enemy panicked and fled, and Israel pursued and defeated them.

- 1 *Then Jerubbaal, who is Gideon, and all the people that were with him, rose up early, and pitched beside the well of Harod: so that the host of the Midianites were on the north side of them, by the hill of Moreh, in the valley.* Then Jerubbaal (that is, Gideon) and all the people who were with him rose early and encamped beside the spring of Harod. And the camp of Midian was north of them, by the hill of Moreh, in the valley.
- 2 *And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people that are with thee are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hands, lest Israel vaunt themselves against me, saying, Mine own hand hath saved me.* The LORD said to Gideon, "The people with you are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hand, lest Israel boast over me, saying, 'My own hand has saved me.'
- 3 *Now therefore go to, proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, Whosoever is fearful and afraid, let him return and depart early from mount Gilead. And there returned of the people twenty and two thousand; and there remained ten thousand.* Now therefore proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, 'Whoever is fearful and trembling, let him return home and hurry away from Mount Gilead.' " Then 22,000 of the people returned, and 10,000 remained.
- 4 *And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people are yet too many; bring them down unto the water, and I will try them for thee there: and it shall be, that of whom I say unto thee, This shall go with thee, the same shall go with thee; and of whomsoever I say unto thee, This shall not go with thee, the same shall not go.* the LORD said to Gideon, "The people are still too many. Take them down to the water. I will test them for you there, and anyone of whom I say to you, 'This one shall go with You,' shall go with You, and anyone of whom I say to you, 'This one shall not go with You,' shall not go."
- 5 *So he brought down the people unto the water: and the LORD said unto Gideon, Every one that lappeth of the water with his tongue, as a dog lappeth, him shalt thou set by himself; likewise every one that boweth down upon his knees to drink.* So He brought the people down to the water. And the LORD said to Gideon, "Every one who laps the water with his tongue, as a dog laps, you shall set by Himself. Likewise, every one who kneels down to drink."

- 6 *And the number of them that lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, were three hundred men: but all the rest of the people bowed down upon their knees to drink water.* the number of those who lapped, putting their hands to their mouths, was 300 men. But all the rest of the people knelt down to drink water.
- 7 *And the LORD said unto Gideon, By the three hundred men that lapped will I save you, and deliver the Midianites into thine hand: and let all the other people go every man unto his place.* the LORD said to Gideon, "With the 300 men who lapped I will save you and give the Midianites into your hand, and let all the others go every man to his home."
- 8 *So the people took victuals in their hand, and their trumpets: and he sent all the rest of Israel every man unto his tent, and retained those three hundred men: and the host of Midian was beneath him in the valley.* So the people took provisions in their hands, and their trumpets, and He sent all the rest of Israel every man to his tent, but retained the 300 men. And the camp of Midian was below Him in the valley.
- 9 *And it came to pass the same night, that the LORD said unto him, Arise, get thee down unto the host; for I have delivered it into thine hand.* That same night the LORD said to Him, "Arise, go down against the camp, for I have given it into Your hand.
- 10 *But if thou fear to go down, go thou with Phurah thy servant down to the host:* But if You are afraid to go down, go down to the camp with Purah Your servant.
- 11 *And thou shalt hear what they say; and afterward shall thine hands be strengthened to go down unto the host. Then went he down with Phurah his servant unto the outside of the armed men that were in the host.* you shall hear what they say, and afterward Your hands shall be strengthened to go down against the camp." Then He went down with Purah His servant to the outposts of the armed men who were in the camp.

- 12 *And the Midianites and the Amalekites and all the children of the east lay along in the valley like grasshoppers for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand by the sea side for multitude.* the Midianites and the Amalekites and all the people of the East lay along the valley like locusts in abundance. Their camels were without number, as the sand that is on the seashore in abundance.
- 13 *And when Gideon was come, behold, there was a man that told a dream unto his fellow, and said, Behold, I dreamed a dream, and, lo, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the host of Midian, and came unto a tent, and smote it that it fell, and overturned it, that the tent lay along.* When Gideon came, a man was telling a dream to his comrade. And he said, "I dreamed a dream, and a cake of barley bread tumbled into the camp of Midian and came to the tent and struck it so that it fell and turned it upside down, so that the tent lay flat."
- 14 *And his fellow answered and said, This is nothing else save the sword of Gideon the son of Joash, a man of Israel: for into his hand hath God delivered Midian, and all the host.* his comrade answered, "This is no other than the sword of Gideon the son of Joash, a man of Israel; God has given into His hand Midian and all the camp."
- 15 *And it was so, when Gideon heard the telling of the dream, and the interpretation thereof, that he worshipped, and returned into the host of Israel, and said, Arise; for the LORD hath delivered into your hand the host of Midian.* As soon as Gideon heard the telling of the dream and its interpretation, He worshiped. And He returned to the camp of Israel and said, "Arise, for the LORD has given the host of Midian into Your hand."
- 16 *And he divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put a trumpet in every man's hand, with empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers.* he divided the 300 men into three companies and put trumpets into the hands of all of them and empty jars, with torches inside the jars.
- 17 *And he said unto them, Look on me, and do likewise: and, behold, when I come to the outside of the camp, it shall be that, as I do, so shall ye do.* he said to them, "Look at me, and do likewise. When I come to the outskirts of the camp, do as I do."

- 18 *When I blow with a trumpet, I and all that are with me, then blow ye the trumpets also on every side of all the camp, and say, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.* When I blow the trumpet, I and all who are with me, then blow the trumpets also on every side of all the camp and shout, 'For the LORD and for Gideon.'
- 19 *So Gideon, and the hundred men that were with him, came unto the outside of the camp in the beginning of the middle watch; and they had but newly set the watch: and they blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers that were in their hands.* So Gideon and the hundred men who were with him came to the outskirts of the camp at the beginning of the middle watch, when they had just set the watch. And they blew the trumpets and smashed the jars that were in their hands.
- 20 *And the three companies blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers, and held the lamps in their left hands, and the trumpets in their right hands to blow withal: and they cried, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.* Then the three companies blew the trumpets and broke the jars. They held in their left hands the torches, and in their right hands the trumpets to blow. And they cried out, "A sword for the LORD and for Gideon!"
- 21 *And they stood every man in his place round about the camp: and all the host ran, and cried, and fled.* Every man stood in his place around the camp. All the army ran. They cried out and fled.
- 22 *And the three hundred blew the trumpets, and the LORD set every man's sword against his fellow, even throughout all the host: and the host fled to Bethshittah in Zererath, and to the border of Abelmeholah, unto Tabbath.* When they blew the 300 trumpets, the LORD set every man's sword against his comrade and against all the army. And the army fled as far as Bethshittah in Zererath, as far as the border of Abelmeholah, unto Tabbath.
- 23 *And the men of Israel gathered themselves together out of Naphtali, and out of Asher, and out of all Manasseh, and pursued after the Midianites.* the men of Israel were called out from Naphtali and from Asher and from all Manasseh. They pursued after Midian.

- 24 *And Gideon sent messengers throughout all mount Ephraim, saying, Come down against the Midianites, and take before them the waters unto Bethbarah and Jordan. Then all the men of Ephraim gathered themselves together, and took the waters unto Bethbarah and Jordan.* Gideon sent messengers throughout all the hill country of Ephraim, saying, "Come down against the Midianites and capture the waters against them, as far as Bethbarah, and also the Jordan." So all the men of Ephraim were called out. They captured the waters as far as Bethbarah, and also the Jordan.
- 25 *And they took two princes of the Midianites, Oreb and Zeeb; and they slew Oreb upon the rock Oreb, and Zeeb they slew at the winepress of Zeeb, and pursued Midian, and brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon on the other side Jordan.* they captured the two princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb. They killed Oreb at the rock of Oreb, and Zeeb they killed at the winepress of Zeeb. Then they pursued Midian. They brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon across the Jordan.

Words in this chapter:

victuals (VIT-ulz) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 6:32; Gen 12:6
v2 — Deut 8:17; 1 Cor 1:27-29; 2 Cor 4:7; Rom 11:18; Zech 12:7
v3 — Deut 20:8; Rev 17:14
v4 — Ps 33:16; 1 Sam 16:7
v7 — 1 Sam 14:6; Isa 41:14-16
v12 — Judg 6:5; Judg 8:10
v15 — 2 Cor 10:4-6; Gen 40:8; Gen 24:48; 2 Chr 20:18-19; Judg 4:14
v16 — 2 Cor 4:7
v17 — Matt 16:24; 1 Cor 11:1
v22 — 1 Kgs 4:12
v25 — Isa 10:26; Judg 8:3-4

Chapter 8

Gideon pursued and captured the Midianite kings Zebah and Zalmunna east of the Jordan. He refused the people's offer to make him king but made a golden ephod that became a snare to Israel; after his death, the people returned to Baal worship.

- 1 *And the men of Ephraim said unto him, Why hast thou served us thus, that thou calledst us not, when thou wentest to fight with the Midianites? And they did chide with him sharply.* Then the men of Ephraim said to him, "What is this that you have done to us, not to call us when you went to fight against Midian?" And they accused him fiercely.
- 2 *And he said unto them, What have I done now in comparison of you? Is not the gleaning of the grapes of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer?* he said to them, "What have I done now in comparison with you? Is not the gleaning of the grapes of Ephraim better than the grape harvest of Abiezer?"
- 3 *God hath delivered into your hands the princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb: and what was I able to do in comparison of you? Then their anger was abated toward him, when he had said that.* God has given into your hands the princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb. What have I been able to do in comparison with you?" Then their anger against Him subsided when He said this.
- 4 *And Gideon came to Jordan, and passed over, he, and the three hundred men that were with him, faint, yet pursuing them.* Gideon came to the Jordan and crossed over, he and the 300 men who were with him, exhausted yet pursuing.
- 5 *And he said unto the men of Succoth, Give, I pray you, loaves of bread unto the people that follow me; for they be faint, and I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, kings of Midian.* So he said to the men of Succoth, "Please give loaves of bread to the people who follow me, for they are exhausted. I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, the kings of Midian."
- 6 *And the princes of Succoth said, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thine army?* the officials of Succoth said, "Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna already in your hand, that we should give bread to your army?"
- 7 *And Gideon said, Therefore when the LORD hath delivered Zebah and Zalmunna into mine hand, then I will tear your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with briers.* So Gideon said, "Well then, when the LORD has given Zebah and Zalmunna into my hand, I will flail Your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with briers."

- 8 *And he went up thence to Penuel, and spake unto them likewise: and the men of Penuel answered him as the men of Succoth had answered him.* from there He went up to Penuel, and spoke to them in the same way, and the men of Penuel answered Him as the men of Succoth had answered.
- 9 *And he spake also unto the men of Penuel, saying, When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower.* he said to the men of Penuel, "When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower."
- 10 *Now Zebah and Zalmunna were in Karkor, and their hosts with them, about fifteen thousand men, all that were left of all the hosts of the children of the east: for there fell an hundred and twenty thousand men that drew sword.* Now Zebah and Zalmunna were in Karkor with their army, about 15,000 men, all who were left of all the army of the people of the East, for there had fallen 120,000 men who drew the sword.
- 11 *And Gideon went up by the way of them that dwelt in tents on the east of Nobah and Jogbehah, and smote the host: for the host was secure.* Gideon went up by the way of the tent dwellers east of Nobah and Jogbehah and attacked the army, for the army felt secure.
- 12 *And when Zebah and Zalmunna fled, he pursued after them, and took the two kings of Midian, Zebah and Zalmunna, and discomfited all the host.* Zebah and Zalmunna fled. He pursued them and captured the two kings of Midian, Zebah and Zalmunna. He threw all the army into a panic.
- 13 *And Gideon the son of Joash returned from battle before the sun was up,* Then Gideon the son of Joash returned from battle before the sun was up.
- 14 *And caught a young man of the men of Succoth, and enquired of him: and he described unto him the princes of Succoth, and the elders thereof, even threescore and seventeen men.* he captured a young man of Succoth and questioned him. And he wrote down for him the officials and elders of Succoth, seventy-seven men.

- 15 *And he came unto the men of Succoth, and said, Behold Zebah and Zalmunna, with whom ye did upbraid me, saying, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thy men that are weary?* he came to the men of Succoth and said, " Zebah and Zalmunna, about whom you taunted me, saying, 'Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna already in your hand, that we should give bread to your men who are exhausted?'"
- 16 *And he took the elders of the city, and thorns of the wilderness and briers, and with them he taught the men of Succoth.* he took the elders of the city. He took thorns of the wilderness and briers and with them taught the men of Succoth a lesson.
- 17 *And he beat down the tower of Penuel, and slew the men of the city.* he broke down the tower of Penuel and killed the men of the city.
- 18 *Then said he unto Zebah and Zalmunna, What manner of men were they whom ye slew at Tabor? And they answered, As thou art, so were they; each one resembled the children of a king.* Then he said to Zebah and Zalmunna, "What manner of men were they whom you slew at Tabor?" They answered, "As you are, so were they. Every one of them resembled the son of a king."
- 19 *And he said, They were my brethren, even the sons of my mother: as the LORD liveth, if ye had saved them alive, I would not slay you.* he said, "They were my brothers, the sons of my mother. As the LORD lives, if You had saved them alive, I would not kill You."
- 20 *And he said unto Jether his firstborn, Up, and slay them. But the youth drew not his sword: for he feared, because he was yet a youth.* So He said to Jether His firstborn, "Rise and kill them!" But the young man did not draw his sword, for He was afraid, because He was still a young man.
- 21 *Then Zebah and Zalmunna said, Rise thou, and fall upon us: for as the man is, so is his strength. And Gideon arose, and slew Zebah and Zalmunna, and took away the ornaments that were on their camels' necks.* Then Zebah and Zalmunna said, "Rise yourself and fall upon us, for as the man is, so is his strength." And Gideon arose and killed Zebah and Zalmunna. He took the crescent ornaments that were on the necks of their camels.

- 22 *Then the men of Israel said unto Gideon, Rule thou over us, both thou, and thy son, and thy son's son also: for thou hast delivered us from the hand of Midian.* Then the men of Israel said to Gideon, "Rule over us, you and your son and your grandson also, for you have saved us from the hand of Midian."
- 23 *And Gideon said unto them, I will not rule over you, neither shall my son rule over you: the LORD shall rule over you.* Gideon said to them, "I will not rule over you, and my son will not rule over You; the LORD will rule over You."
- 24 *And Gideon said unto them, I would desire a request of you, that ye would give me every man the earrings of his prey. (For they had golden earrings, because they were Ishmaelites.)* Gideon said to them, "Let me make a request of you: every one of you give me the earrings from his plunder." For they had golden earrings, because they were Ishmaelites.
- 25 *And they answered, We will willingly give them. And they spread a garment, and did cast therein every man the earrings of his prey.* they answered, "We will willingly give them." And they spread a cloak, and every man threw in it the earrings of his plunder.
- 26 *And the weight of the golden earrings that he requested was a thousand and seven hundred shekels of gold; beside ornaments, and collars, and purple raiment that was on the kings of Midian, and beside the chains that were about their camels' necks.* the weight of the golden earrings that he requested was 1,700 shekels of gold, besides the crescent ornaments and the pendants and the purple garments worn by the kings of Midian, and besides the collars that were around the necks of their camels.
- 27 *And Gideon made an ephod thereof, and put it in his city, even in Ophrah: and all Israel went thither a whoring after it: which thing became a snare unto Gideon, and to his house.* Gideon made an ephod of it and put it in his city, in Ophrah. And all Israel whored after it there. It became a snare to Gideon and to his family.
- 28 *Thus was Midian subdued before the children of Israel, so that they lifted up their heads no more. And the country was in quietness forty years in the days of Gideon.* So Midian was subdued before the people of Israel. They raised their heads no more. And the land had rest forty years in the days of Gideon.

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| 29 | <i>And Jerubbaal the son of Joash went and dwelt in his own house.</i> | Jerubbaal the son of Joash went and lived in his own house. |
| 30 | <i>And Gideon had threescore and ten sons of his body begotten: for he had many wives.</i> | Now Gideon had seventy sons, his own seed, for he had many wives. |
| 31 | <i>And his concubine that was in Shechem, she also bare him a son, whose name he called Abimelech.</i> | his concubine who was in Shechem also bore him a son. He called his name Abimelech. |
| 32 | <i>And Gideon the son of Joash died in a good old age, and was buried in the sepulchre of Joash his father, in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.</i> | Gideon the son of Joash died in a good old age and was buried in the tomb of Joash his father, at Ophrah of the Abiezrites. |
| 33 | <i>And it came to pass, as soon as Gideon was dead, that the children of Israel turned again, and went a whoring after Baalim, and made Baalberith their god.</i> | As soon as Gideon died, the people of Israel turned again and whored after the Baals and made Baal-berith their god. |
| 34 | <i>And the children of Israel remembered not the LORD their God, who had delivered them out of the hands of all their enemies on every side:</i> | the people of Israel did not remember the LORD their God, Who had delivered them from the hand of all their enemies on every side, |
| 35 | <i>Neither shewed they kindness to the house of Jerubbaal, namely Gideon, according to all the goodness which he had shewed unto Israel.</i> | they did not show mercy to the family of Jerubbaal (that is, Gideon) in return for all the good that he had done to Israel. |

Words in this chapter:

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Cross-References:

v3 — Prov 15:1

v4 — Gal 6:9; 2 Cor 4:16

v5 — Gen 33:17

v23 — Isa 33:22; 1 Sam 12:12

v24 — Gen 25:13

v27 — Ps 106:39; Judg 18:14; Deut 7:16; Judg 17:5

v30 — Judg 9:5; Judg 9:2

v33 — Judg 9:4; Judg 9:46; Judg 2:19

v34 — Ps 78:42; Ps 106:21; Ps 78:11

Chapter 9

Abimelech, Gideon's son by a concubine, killed seventy of his brothers and was made king at Shechem; only Jotham escaped and pronounced a parable-curse. Shechem later turned against Abimelech, and he was killed when a woman dropped a millstone on his head at Thebez.

- 1 *And Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal went to Shechem unto his mother's brethren, and communed with them, and with all the family of the house of his mother's father, saying,* Now Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal went to Shechem to his mother's brothers and said to them and to the whole clan of his mother's family,
- 2 *Speak, I pray you, in the ears of all the men of Shechem, Whether is better for you, either that all the sons of Jerubbaal, which are threescore and ten persons, reign over you, or that one reign over you? remember also that I am your bone and your flesh.* "Say in the ears of all the leaders of Shechem, 'Which is better for you, that all seventy of the sons of Jerubbaal rule over you, or that one rule over you?' Remember also that I am your bone and your flesh."
- 3 *And his mother's brethren spake of him in the ears of all the men of Shechem all these words: and their hearts inclined to follow Abimelech; for they said, He is our brother.* his mother's brothers spoke all these words on his behalf in the ears of all the leaders of Shechem. Their hearts inclined to follow Abimelech, for they said, "He is our brother."
- 4 *And they gave him threescore and ten pieces of silver out of the house of Baalberith, wherewith Abimelech hired vain and light persons, which followed him.* they gave him seventy pieces of silver out of the house of Baal-berith with which Abimelech hired worthless and reckless fellows, who followed him.

- 5 *And he went unto his father's house at Ophrah, and slew his brethren the sons of Jerubbaal, being threescore and ten persons, upon one stone: notwithstanding yet Jotham the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left; for he hid himself.* he went to his father's house at Ophrah and killed his brothers the sons of Jerubbaal, seventy men, on one stone. But Jotham the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left, for he hid himself.
- 6 *And all the men of Shechem gathered together, and all the house of Millo, and went, and made Abimelech king, by the plain of the pillar that was in Shechem.* all the leaders of Shechem and all the house of Millo came together. They went and made Abimelech king, by the plain of the pillar at Shechem.
- 7 *And when they told it to Jotham, he went and stood in the top of mount Gerizim, and lifted up his voice, and cried, and said unto them, Hearken unto me, ye men of Shechem, that God may hearken unto you.* When it was told to Jotham, he went and stood on top of Mount Gerizim and cried aloud and said to them, "Listen to me, you leaders of Shechem, that God may listen to you.
- 8 *The trees went forth on a time to anoint a king over them; and they said unto the olive tree, Reign thou over us.* The trees once went out to anoint a king over them. They said to the olive tree, 'Reign over us.'
- 9 *But the olive tree said unto them, Should I leave my fatness, wherewith by me they honour God and man, and go to be promoted over the trees?* But the olive tree said to them, 'Shall I leave my abundance, by which gods and men are honored, and go hold sway over the trees?'
- 10 *And the trees said to the fig tree, Come thou, and reign over us.* the trees said to the fig tree, 'You come and reign over us.'
- 11 *But the fig tree said unto them, Should I forsake my sweetness, and my good fruit, and go to be promoted over the trees?* But the fig tree said to them, 'Shall I leave my sweetness and my good fruit and go hold sway over the trees?'
- 12 *Then said the trees unto the vine, Come thou, and reign over us.* the trees said to the vine, 'You come and reign over us.'

- 13 *And the vine said unto them, Should I leave my wine, which cheereth God and man, and go to be promoted over the trees?* But the vine said to them, 'Shall I leave my wine that cheers God and men and go hold sway over the trees?'
- 14 *Then said all the trees unto the bramble, Come thou, and reign over us.* Then all the trees said to the bramble, 'You come and reign over us.'
- 15 *And the bramble said unto the trees, If in truth ye anoint me king over you, then come and put your trust in my shadow: and if not, let fire come out of the bramble, and devour the cedars of Lebanon.* the bramble said to the trees, 'If in good faith you are anointing me king over you, then come and take refuge in my shade, but if not, let fire come out of the bramble and devour the cedars of Lebanon.'
- 16 *Now therefore, if ye have done truly and sincerely, in that ye have made Abimelech king, and if ye have dealt well with Jerubbaal and his house, and have done unto him according to the deserving of his hands;* Now therefore, if you acted in good faith and integrity when you made Abimelech king, and if you have dealt well with Jerubbaal and his house and have done to him as his deeds deserved—
- 17 *(For my father fought for you, and adventured his life far, and delivered you out of the hand of Midian:* for my father fought for you and risked his life and delivered you from the hand of Midian,
- 18 *And ye are risen up against my father's house this day, and have slain his sons, threescore and ten persons, upon one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his maidservant, king over the men of Shechem, because he is your brother;)* you have risen up against my father's house this day and have killed his sons, seventy men on one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his female servant, king over the leaders of Shechem, because he is your relative—
- 19 *If ye then have dealt truly and sincerely with Jerubbaal and with his house this day, then rejoice ye in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you:* if you then have acted in good faith and integrity with Jerubbaal and with his house this day, then rejoice in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you.

- 20 *But if not, let fire come out from Abimelech, and devour the men of Shechem, and the house of Millo; and let fire come out from the men of Shechem, and from the house of Millo, and devour Abimelech.* But if not, let fire come out from Abimelech and devour the leaders of Shechem and the house of Millo. Let fire come out from the leaders of Shechem and from the house of Millo and devour Abimelech."
- 21 *And Jotham ran away, and fled, and went to Beer, and dwelt there, for fear of Abimelech his brother.* Then Jotham ran away and fled and went to Beer and lived there, because of Abimelech his brother.
- 22 *When Abimelech had reigned three years over Israel,* Abimelech ruled over Israel three years.
- 23 *Then God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Shechem; and the men of Shechem dealt treacherously with Abimelech:* God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the leaders of Shechem, and the leaders of Shechem dealt treacherously with Abimelech,
- 24 *That the cruelty done to the threescore and ten sons of Jerubbaal might come, and their blood be laid upon Abimelech their brother, which slew them; and upon the men of Shechem, which aided him in the killing of his brethren.* that the violence done to the seventy sons of Jerubbaal might come. Their blood be laid on Abimelech their brother, who killed them, and on the men of Shechem, who strengthened his hands to kill his brothers.
- 25 *And the men of Shechem set liers in wait for him in the top of the mountains, and they robbed all that came along that way by them: and it was told Abimelech.* the leaders of Shechem put men in ambush against him on the mountaintops. They robbed all who passed by them along that way. And it was told to Abimelech.
- 26 *And Gaal the son of Ebed came with his brethren, and went over to Shechem: and the men of Shechem put their confidence in him.* Gaal the son of Ebed came with his brothers and moved to Shechem, and the leaders of Shechem put their confidence in him.

- 27 *And they went out into the fields, and gathered their vineyards, and trode the grapes, and made merry, and went into the house of their god, and did eat and drink, and cursed Abimelech.* They went out into the fields, gathered the grapes from their vineyards, trod them, and held a festival. They went into the house of their god, ate and drank, and cursed Abimelech.
- 28 *And Gaal the son of Ebed said, Who is Abimelech, and who is Shechem, that we should serve him? is not he the son of Jerubbaal? and Zebul his officer? serve the men of Hamor the father of Shechem: for why should we serve him?* Gaal the son of Ebed said, "Who is Abimelech, and who is Shechem, that we should serve him? Is he not the son of Jerubbaal, and is not Zebul his officer? Serve the men of Hamor the father of Shechem. Why should we serve him?"
- 29 *And would to God this people were under my hand! then would I remove Abimelech. And he said to Abimelech, Increase thine army, and come out.* If only this people were under my command, then I would remove Abimelech." He said to Abimelech, "Increase your army and come out."
- 30 *And when Zebul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal the son of Ebed, his anger was kindled.* When Zebul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal the son of Ebed, his anger was kindled.
- 31 *And he sent messengers unto Abimelech privily, saying, Behold, Gaal the son of Ebed and his brethren be come to Shechem; and, behold, they fortify the city against thee.* He sent messengers secretly to Abimelech, saying, "Gaal the son of Ebed and his brothers have come to Shechem, and they are stirring up the city against you.
- 32 *Now therefore up by night, thou and the people that is with thee, and lie in wait in the field:* Now therefore go up by night, you and the people who are with you, and lie in wait in the field.
- 33 *And it shall be, that in the morning, as soon as the sun is up, thou shalt rise early, and set upon the city: and, behold, when he and the people that is with him come out against thee, then mayest thou do to them as thou shalt find occasion.* In the morning, as soon as the sun is up, rise early and rush upon the city. And when he and the people who are with him come out against you, you may do to them as your hand finds opportunity."

- 34 *And Abimelech rose up, and all the people that were with him, by night, and they laid wait against Shechem in four companies.* Abimelech and all the people who were with him rose by night and set an ambush against Shechem in four companies.
- 35 *And Gaal the son of Ebed went out, and stood in the entering of the gate of the city: and Abimelech rose up, and the people that were with him, from lying in wait.* Gaal the son of Ebed went out and stood at the entrance of the gate of the city. Abimelech and the people who were with him rose up from their ambush.
- 36 *And when Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul, Behold, there come people down from the top of the mountains. And Zebul said unto him, Thou seest the shadow of the mountains as if they were men.* When Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul, "Look, people are coming down from the tops of the mountains." Zebul said to him, "You see the shadow of the mountains as if it were men."
- 37 *And Gaal spake again and said, See there come people down by the middle of the land, and another company come along by the plain of Meonenim.* Gaal spoke again and said, "Look, people are coming down from the central highland, and one company is coming by the way of the oak of Meonenim."
- 38 *Then said Zebul unto him, Where is now thy mouth, wherewith thou saidst, Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him? is not this the people that thou hast despised? go out, I pray now, and fight with them.* Then Zebul said to him, "Where is your mouth now, with which you said, 'Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him?' Are these not the people whom you despised? Go out now and fight with them."
- 39 *And Gaal went out before the men of Shechem, and fought with Abimelech.* Gaal went out before the leaders of Shechem and fought with Abimelech.
- 40 *And Abimelech chased him, and he fled before him, and many were overthrown and wounded, even unto the entering of the gate.* Abimelech pursued him, and Gaal fled before him. Many were wounded and fell, all the way to the entrance of the gate.

- 41 *And Abimelech dwelt at Arumah: and Zebul thrust out Gaal and his brethren, that they should not dwell in Shechem.* Abimelech lived at Arumah, and Zebul drove out Gaal and his brothers, so that they could not live in Shechem.
- 42 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that the people went out into the field; and they told Abimelech.* On the next day the people went out into the field, and it was told to Abimelech.
- 43 *And he took the people, and divided them into three companies, and laid wait in the field, and looked, and, behold, the people were come forth out of the city; and he rose up against them, and smote them.* He took his people and divided them into three companies and laid in wait in the field. He looked, and the people were coming out of the city. So he rose against them and struck them.
- 44 *And Abimelech, and the company that was with him, rushed forward, and stood in the entering of the gate of the city: and the two other companies ran upon all the people that were in the fields, and slew them.* Abimelech and the company with him rushed forward and stood at the entrance of the gate of the city. The other two companies rushed against all who were in the field and killed them.
- 45 *And Abimelech fought against the city all that day; and he took the city, and slew the people that was therein, and beat down the city, and sowed it with salt.* Abimelech fought against the city all that day. He took the city, killed the people who were in it, broke down the city, and sowed it with salt.
- 46 *And when all the men of the tower of Shechem heard that, they entered into an hold of the house of the god Berith.* When all the leaders of the tower of Shechem heard of it, they entered the stronghold of the house of the god Berith.
- 47 *And it was told Abimelech, that all the men of the tower of Shechem were gathered together.* It was told to Abimelech that all the leaders of the tower of Shechem had gathered together.

- 48 *And Abimelech gat him up to mount Zalmon, he and all the people that were with him; and Abimelech took an axe in his hand, and cut down a bough from the trees, and took it, and laid it on his shoulder, and said unto the people that were with him, What ye have seen me do, make haste, and do as I have done.* Abimelech went up to Mount Zalmon, he and all the people who were with him. Abimelech took an axe in his hand, cut down a branch from the trees, lifted it, and laid it on his shoulder. He said to the people who were with him, "What you have seen me do, hurry and do as I have done."
- 49 *And all the people likewise cut down every man his bough, and followed Abimelech, and put them to the hold, and set the hold on fire upon them; so that all the men of the tower of Shechem died also, about a thousand men and women.* All the people likewise cut down each his branch and followed Abimelech. They put the branches against the stronghold and set it on fire over them, so that all the people of the tower of Shechem died also — about a thousand men and women.
- 50 *Then went Abimelech to Thebez, and encamped against Thebez, and took it.* Then Abimelech went to Thebez and encamped against Thebez and captured it.
- 51 *But there was a strong tower within the city, and thither fled all the men and women, and all they of the city, and shut it to them, and gat them up to the top of the tower.* But there was a strong tower within the city. All the men and women and all the leaders of the city fled to it and shut themselves in. They went up to the roof of the tower.
- 52 *And Abimelech came unto the tower, and fought against it, and went hard unto the door of the tower to burn it with fire.* Abimelech came to the tower and fought against it and drew near to the door of the tower to burn it with fire.
- 53 *And a certain woman cast a piece of a millstone upon Abimelech's head, and all to brake his skull.* a certain woman threw an upper millstone on Abimelech's head and crushed his skull.

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| <p>54 <i>Then he called hastily unto the young man his armourbearer, and said unto him, Draw thy sword, and slay me, that men say not of me, A woman slew him. And his young man thrust him through, and he died.</i></p> <p>55 <i>And when the men of Israel saw that Abimelech was dead, they departed every man unto his place.</i></p> <p>56 <i>Thus God rendered the wickedness of Abimelech, which he did unto his father, in slaying his seventy brethren:</i></p> <p>57 <i>And all the evil of the men of Shechem did God render upon their heads: and upon them came the curse of Jotham the son of Jerubbaal.</i></p> | <p>Then he called quickly to the young man his armor-bearer and said to him, "Draw your sword and kill me, lest they say of me, 'A woman killed him.' " And his young man thrust him through. He died.</p> <p>when the men of Israel saw that Abimelech was dead, everyone departed to his home.</p> <p>Thus God returned the evil of Abimelech, which He committed against His father in killing His seventy brothers.</p> <p>God also made all the evil of the men of Shechem return on their heads, and upon them came the curse of Jotham the son of Jerubbaal.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

faith — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 8:31
- v2 — Judg 8:30; Gen 29:14
- v4 — Judg 8:33
- v5 — 2 Kgs 11:1-2
- v7 — Deut 11:29
- v15 — Isa 30:2
- v18 — Judg 9:5-6
- v23 — Isa 33:1
- v28 — 1 Sam 25:10; Gen 34:2
- v45 — 2 Kgs 3:25; Deut 29:23
- v48 — Ps 68:14
- v53 — 2 Sam 11:21

Chapter 10

Tola and Jair judged Israel for a combined forty-five years. Israel again served foreign gods and was oppressed by the Philistines and Ammonites for eighteen years; when they cried out, the LORD told them to call on the gods they had chosen, but relented when they put away their idols.

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| 1 | <i>And after Abimelech there arose to defend Israel Tola the son of Puah the son of Dodo, a man of Issachar; and he dwelt in Shamir in mount Ephraim.</i> | After Abimelech there arose to save Israel Tola the son of Puah, son of Dodo, a man of Issachar. He lived at Shamir in the hill country of Ephraim. |
| 2 | <i>And he judged Israel twenty and three years, and died, and was buried in Shamir.</i> | he judged Israel twenty-three years. Then He died and was buried at Shamir. |
| 3 | <i>And after him arose Jair, a Gileadite, and judged Israel twenty and two years.</i> | After Him arose Jair the Gileadite, who judged Israel twenty-two years. |
| 4 | <i>And he had thirty sons that rode on thirty ass colts, and they had thirty cities, which are called Havothjair unto this day, which are in the land of Gilead.</i> | he had thirty sons who rode on thirty donkeys. They had thirty cities, called Havothjair to this day, which are in the land of Gilead. |
| 5 | <i>And Jair died, and was buried in Camon.</i> | Jair died and was buried in Kamon. |
| 6 | <i>And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD, and served Baalim, and Ashtaroth, and the gods of Syria, and the gods of Zidon, and the gods of Moab, and the gods of the children of Ammon, and the gods of the Philistines, and forsook the LORD, and served not him.</i> | The people of Israel again did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and served the Baals and the Ashtaroth, the gods of Syria, the gods of Sidon, the gods of Moab, the gods of the Ammonites, and the gods of the Philistines. And they forsook the LORD and did not serve Him. |
| 7 | <i>And the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them into the hands of the Philistines, and into the hands of the children of Ammon.</i> | So the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He sold them into the hand of the Philistines and into the hand of the Ammonites, |

- 8 *And that year they vexed and oppressed the children of Israel: eighteen years, all the children of Israel that were on the other side Jordan in the land of the Amorites, which is in Gilead.* they crushed and oppressed the people of Israel that year. For eighteen years they oppressed all the people of Israel who were beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorites, which is in Gilead.
- 9 *Moreover the children of Ammon passed over Jordan to fight also against Judah, and against Benjamin, and against the house of Ephraim; so that Israel was sore distressed.* the Ammonites crossed the Jordan to fight also against Judah and against Benjamin and against the house of Ephraim, so that Israel was severely distressed.
- 10 *And the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, saying, We have sinned against thee, both because we have forsaken our God, and also served Baalim.* the people of Israel cried out to the LORD, saying, "We have sinned against You, because we have forsaken our God and have served the Baals."
- 11 *And the LORD said unto the children of Israel, Did not I deliver you from the Egyptians, and from the Amorites, from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines?* the LORD said to the people of Israel, "Did I not save you from the Egyptians and from the Amorites, from the Ammonites and from the Philistines?"
- 12 *The Zidonians also, and the Amalekites, and the Maonites, did oppress you; and ye cried to me, and I delivered you out of their hand.* The Sidonians also, and the Amalekites and the Maonites oppressed You, and You cried out to me. I saved You out of their hand.
- 13 *Yet ye have forsaken me, and served other gods: wherefore I will deliver you no more.* Yet You have forsaken me and served other gods; therefore I will save You no more.
- 14 *Go and cry unto the gods which ye have chosen; let them deliver you in the time of your tribulation.* Go and cry out to the gods whom You have chosen; let them save You in the time of Your distress."

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| <p>15 <i>And the children of Israel said unto the LORD, We have sinned: do thou unto us whatsoever seemeth good unto thee; deliver us only, we pray thee, this day.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And they put away the strange gods from among them, and served the LORD: and his soul was grieved for the misery of Israel.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Then the children of Ammon were gathered together, and encamped in Gilead. And the children of Israel assembled themselves together, and encamped in Mizpeh.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the people and princes of Gilead said one to another, What man is he that will begin to fight against the children of Ammon? he shall be head over all the inhabitants of Gilead.</i></p> | <p>the people of Israel said to the LORD, "We have sinned; do to us whatever seems good to You. Only please deliver us this day."</p> <p>So they put away the foreign gods from among them and served the LORD. His soul was grieved for the misery of Israel.</p> <p>Then the Ammonites were called to arms. They encamped in Gilead. And the people of Israel came together and encamped at Mizpah.</p> <p>the people, the leaders of Gilead, said one to another, "Who is the man who will begin to fight against the Ammonites? He shall be head over all the inhabitants of Gilead."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 2:16
- v6 — 2 Kgs 23:13
- v10 — 1 Sam 12:10; Ps 107:28; Ps 107:19; Ps 107:13
- v11 — Ex 14:30
- v13 — Jer 2:13; 1 Chr 28:9; Judg 2:12
- v14 — Jer 2:28; Deut 32:37-38
- v15 — 1 Sam 3:18; 2 Sam 15:26
- v16 — Isa 63:9; Ps 106:44-45
- v17 — Judg 11:29

Chapter 11

Jephthah the Gileadite, a mighty warrior and son of a prostitute, was recalled from exile to lead Israel against the Ammonites. He defeated the Ammonites in battle but was bound by a rash vow that cost him his daughter.

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| <p>1 <i>Now Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty man of valour, and he was the son of an harlot: and Gilead begat Jephthah.</i></p> | <p>Now Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty warrior. But He was the son of a prostitute. Gilead was the father of Jephthah.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jephthah** (JEF-thah) — "he opens" — A Gileadite warrior and outcast, son of a prostitute, who was recalled by his people to lead them against Ammon. He made a rash vow to the LORD that cost him his daughter. He judged Israel six years.

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| <p>2 <i>And Gilead's wife bare him sons; and his wife's sons grew up, and they thrust out Jephthah, and said unto him, Thou shalt not inherit in our father's house; for thou art the son of a strange woman.</i></p> | <p>Gilead's wife also bore Him sons. And when his wife's sons grew up, they drove Jephthah out and said to Him, "You shall not have an inheritance in our father's house, for You are the son of another woman."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then Jephthah fled from his brethren, and dwelt in the land of Tob: and there were gathered vain men to Jephthah, and went out with him.</i></p> | <p>Then Jephthah fled from His brothers and lived in the land of Tob, and worthless fellows collected around Jephthah and went out with Him.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And it came to pass in process of time, that the children of Ammon made war against Israel.</i></p> | <p>After a time the Ammonites made war against Israel.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And it was so, that when the children of Ammon made war against Israel, the elders of Gilead went to fetch Jephthah out of the land of Tob:</i></p> | <p>when the Ammonites made war against Israel, the elders of Gilead went to bring Jephthah from the land of Tob.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And they said unto Jephthah, Come, and be our captain, that we may fight with the children of Ammon.</i></p> | <p>they said to Jephthah, "Come and be our leader, that we may fight against the Ammonites."</p> |

- 7 *And Jephthah said unto the elders of Gilead, Did not ye hate me, and expel me out of my father's house? and why are ye come unto me now when ye are in distress?* But Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead, "Did you not hate me and drive me out of my father's house? Why have you come to me now when you are in distress?"
- 8 *And the elders of Gilead said unto Jephthah, Therefore we turn again to thee now, that thou mayest go with us, and fight against the children of Ammon, and be our head over all the inhabitants of Gilead.* the elders of Gilead said to Jephthah, "That is why we have turned to You now, that You may go with us and fight against the Ammonites and be our head over all the inhabitants of Gilead."
- 9 *And Jephthah said unto the elders of Gilead, If ye bring me home again to fight against the children of Ammon, and the LORD deliver them before me, shall I be your head?* Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead, "If you bring me home again to fight against the Ammonites, and the LORD gives them over to me, I will be your head."
- 10 *And the elders of Gilead said unto Jephthah, The LORD be witness between us, if we do not so according to thy words.* the elders of Gilead said to Jephthah, "The LORD will be witness between us, if we do not do as You say."
- 11 *Then Jephthah went with the elders of Gilead, and the people made him head and captain over them: and Jephthah uttered all his words before the LORD in Mizpah.* So Jephthah went with the elders of Gilead, and the people made him head and leader over them. And Jephthah spoke all His words before the LORD at Mizpah.
- 12 *And Jephthah sent messengers unto the king of the children of Ammon, saying, What hast thou to do with me, that thou art come against me to fight in my land?* Then Jephthah sent messengers to the king of the Ammonites, saying, "What do you have against me, that you have come to me to fight in my land?"

- 13 *And the king of the children of Ammon answered unto the messengers of Jephthah, Because Israel took away my land, when they came up out of Egypt, from Arnon even unto Jabbok, and unto Jordan: now therefore restore those lands again peaceably.* The king of the Ammonites answered the messengers of Jephthah, "Because Israel took away my land, when they came up out of Egypt, from the Arnon to the Jabbok and to the Jordan. Now therefore restore those lands again peaceably."
- 14 *And Jephthah sent messengers again unto the king of the children of Ammon:* Jephthah again sent messengers to the king of the Ammonites,
- 15 *And said unto him, Thus saith Jephthah, Israel took not away the land of Moab, nor the land of the children of Ammon:* and said to him, "Thus says Jephthah: Israel did not take away the land of Moab or the land of the Ammonites.
- 16 *But when Israel came up from Egypt, and walked through the wilderness unto the Red sea, and came to Kadesh;* But when Israel came up from Egypt and walked through the wilderness to the Red sea and came to Kadesh,
- 17 *Then Israel sent messengers unto the king of Edom, saying, Let me, I pray thee, pass through thy land: but the king of Edom would not hearken thereto. And in like manner they sent unto the king of Moab: but he would not consent: and Israel abode in Kadesh.* Israel sent messengers to the king of Edom, saying, 'Let me pass through your land.' But the king of Edom would not listen. In the same way they sent to the king of Moab, but he would not consent. So Israel stayed at Kadesh.
- 18 *Then they went along through the wilderness, and compassed the land of Edom, and the land of Moab, and came by the east side of the land of Moab, and pitched on the other side of Arnon, but came not within the border of Moab: for Arnon was the border of Moab.* Then they journeyed through the wilderness and went around the land of Edom and the land of Moab. They came by the east side of the land of Moab and camped on the other side of the Arnon. They did not enter the territory of Moab, for the Arnon was the border of Moab.

- 19 *And Israel sent messengers unto Sihon king of the Amorites, the king of Heshbon; and Israel said unto him, Let us pass, we pray thee, through thy land into my place.* Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, king of Heshbon. Israel said to him, 'Please let us pass through your land to our place.'
- 20 *But Sihon trusted not Israel to pass through his coast: but Sihon gathered all his people together, and pitched in Jahaz, and fought against Israel.* But Sihon did not trust Israel to pass through his territory. Instead, Sihon gathered all his people together, encamped at Jahaz, and fought with Israel.
- 21 *And the LORD God of Israel delivered Sihon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and they smote them: so Israel possessed all the land of the Amorites, the inhabitants of that country.* The LORD God of Israel gave Sihon and all His people into the hand of Israel, and they struck them. So Israel took possession of all the land of the Amorites who lived in that country.
- 22 *And they possessed all the coasts of the Amorites, from Arnon even unto Jabbok, and from the wilderness even unto Jordan.* They took possession of all the territory of the Amorites from the Arnon to the Jabbok, and from the wilderness to the Jordan.
- 23 *So now the LORD God of Israel hath dispossessed the Amorites from before his people Israel, and shouldest thou possess it?* So now the LORD God of Israel has dispossessed the Amorites from before His people Israel — and should You possess it?
- 24 *Wilt not thou possess that which Chemosh thy god giveth thee to possess? So whosoever the LORD our God shall drive out from before us, them will we possess.* Will You not possess what Chemosh Your god gives You to possess? So whatever the LORD our God has driven out from before us, that we will possess.
- 25 *And now art thou any thing better than Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab? did he ever strive against Israel, or did he ever fight against them,* Are You any better than Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab? Did He ever contend with Israel, or did He ever fight against them?

- 26 *While Israel dwelt in Heshbon and her towns, and in Aroer and her towns, and in all the cities that be along by the coasts of Arnon, three hundred years? why therefore did ye not recover them within that time?* While Israel lived in Heshbon and its villages, in Aroer and its villages, and in all the cities along the banks of the Arnon — for three hundred years — why did You not recover them in that time?
- 27 *Wherefore I have not sinned against thee, but thou doest me wrong to war against me: the LORD the Judge be judge this day between the children of Israel and the children of Ammon.* I therefore have not sinned against You, but You do me wrong by making war against me. May the LORD, the Judge, be judge this day between the people of Israel and the people of Ammon."
- 28 *Howbeit the king of the children of Ammon hearkened not unto the words of Jephthah which he sent him.* But the king of the Ammonites did not listen to the words of Jephthah that he sent him.
- 29 *Then the Spirit of the LORD came upon Jephthah, and he passed over Gilead, and Manasseh, and passed over Mizpeh of Gilead, and from Mizpeh of Gilead he passed over unto the children of Ammon.* Then the Spirit of the LORD was upon Jephthah. He passed through Gilead and Manasseh and passed on to Mizpah of Gilead, and from Mizpah of Gilead He passed on to the Ammonites.
- 30 *And Jephthah vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou shalt without fail deliver the children of Ammon into mine hands,* Jephthah made a vow to the LORD and said, "If You will give the Ammonites into my hand,
- 31 *Then it shall be, that whatsoever cometh forth of the doors of my house to meet me, when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, shall surely be the LORD's, and I will offer it up for a burnt offering.* then whatever comes out from the doors of my house to meet me when I return in peace from the Ammonites shall be the LORD's. I will offer it up for a burnt offering."
- 32 *So Jephthah passed over unto the children of Ammon to fight against them; and the LORD delivered them into his hands.* So Jephthah crossed over to the Ammonites to fight against them. The LORD gave them into His hand.

- 33 *And he smote them from Aroer, even till thou come to Minnith, even twenty cities, and unto the plain of the vineyards, with a very great slaughter. Thus the children of Ammon were subdued before the children of Israel.* he struck them from Aroer to the neighborhood of Minnith, twenty cities, and unto the plain of the vineyards, with a great blow. So the Ammonites were subdued before the people of Israel.
- 34 *And Jephthah came to Mizpeh unto his house, and, behold, his daughter came out to meet him with timbrels and with dances: and she was his only child; beside her he had neither son nor daughter.* Then Jephthah came to His home at Mizpah. And His daughter came out to meet Him with tambourines and with dancing. She was His only child; besides her He had neither son nor daughter.
- 35 *And it came to pass, when he saw her, that he rent his clothes, and said, Alas, my daughter! thou hast brought me very low, and thou art one of them that trouble me: for I have opened my mouth unto the LORD, and I cannot go back.* as soon as He saw her, He tore His clothes and said, "Alas, my daughter! You have brought me very low, and You have become the cause of great trouble to me. For I have opened my mouth to the LORD. I cannot take back my vow."
- 36 *And she said unto him, My father, if thou hast opened thy mouth unto the LORD, do to me according to that which hath proceeded out of thy mouth; forasmuch as the LORD hath taken vengeance for thee of thine enemies, even of the children of Ammon.* she said to Him, "My father, You have opened Your mouth to the LORD; do to me according to what has gone out of Your mouth, now that the LORD has avenged You on Your enemies, on the Ammonites."
- 37 *And she said unto her father, Let this thing be done for me: let me alone two months, that I may go up and down upon the mountains, and bewail my virginity, I and my fellows.* So she said to her father, "Let this thing be done for me: leave me alone two months, that I may go up and down on the mountains and weep for my virginity, I and my companions."

- 38 *And he said, Go. And he sent her away for two months: and she went with her companions, and bewailed her virginity upon the mountains.* he said, "Go." Then He sent her away for two months. She departed, she and her companions, and wept for her virginity on the mountains.
- 39 *And it came to pass at the end of two months, that she returned unto her father, who did with her according to his vow which he had vowed: and she knew no man. And it was a custom in Israel,* at the end of two months, she returned to her father, who did with her according to His vow that He had made. She had never known a man. And it became a custom in Israel
- 40 *That the daughters of Israel went yearly to lament the daughter of Jephthah the Gileadite four days in a year.* that the daughters of Israel went year by year to lament the daughter of Jephthah the Gileadite four days in the year.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Heb 11:32; Judg 6:12; 2 Kgs 5:1
v3 — Judg 9:4; 1 Sam 22:2
v5 — 1 Cor 1:27-29
v7 — Gen 45:4-5; Rev 3:9; Prov 17:17; Acts 7:9-14; Isa 60:14
v10 — Jer 42:5; Gen 31:50
v11 — Judg 20:1; 1 Sam 10:17; Jas 1:5; Judg 10:17; 1 Sam 11:15
v16 — Deut 1:40; Num 14:25
v24 — Num 21:29; Ps 78:55; Mic 4:5
v27 — Gen 18:25; Gen 16:5; 1 Sam 24:12; 1 Sam 24:15; Gen 31:53
v29 — Num 11:25; Judg 13:25; Judg 3:10
v30 — Gen 28:20; 1 Sam 1:11; Eccl 5:4-5; Eccl 5:1-2; Num 30:2-16
v34 — Jer 31:4; Ex 15:20

Chapter 12

The men of Ephraim quarreled with Jephthah for not summoning them to fight, and a civil war broke out in which 42,000 Ephraimites were killed at the fords of the Jordan, identified by their inability to say "Shibboleth." Ibzan, Elon, and Abdon judged Israel after Jephthah.

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| 1 <i>And the men of Ephraim gathered themselves together, and went northward, and said unto Jephthah, Wherefore passedst thou over to fight against the children of Ammon, and didst not call us to go with thee? we will burn thine house upon thee with fire.</i> | The men of Ephraim were called to arms. They went northward and said to Jephthah, "Why did you cross over to fight against the Ammonites and did not call us to go with you? We will burn your house over you with fire." |
| 2 <i>And Jephthah said unto them, I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon; and when I called you, ye delivered me not out of their hands.</i> | Jephthah said to them, "I and my people had a great dispute with the Ammonites, and when I called you, you did not save me from their hand. |
| 3 <i>And when I saw that ye delivered me not, I put my life in my hands, and passed over against the children of Ammon, and the LORD delivered them into my hand: wherefore then are ye come up unto me this day, to fight against me?</i> | when I saw that You would not save me, I took my life in my hand and crossed over against the Ammonites. The LORD gave them into my hand. Why then have You come up to me this day to fight against me?" |
| 4 <i>Then Jephthah gathered together all the men of Gilead, and fought with Ephraim: and the men of Gilead smote Ephraim, because they said, Ye Gileadites are fugitives of Ephraim among the Ephraimites, and among the Manassites.</i> | Then Jephthah gathered all the men of Gilead and fought with Ephraim. And the men of Gilead struck Ephraim, because they said, "You are fugitives of Ephraim, you Gileadites, in the midst of Ephraim and Manasseh." |

- 5 *And the Gileadites took the passages of Jordan before the Ephraimites: and it was so, that when those Ephraimites which were escaped said, Let me go over; that the men of Gilead said unto him, Art thou an Ephraimite? If he said, Nay;* the Gileadites captured the fords of the Jordan against the Ephraimites. And when any of the fugitives of Ephraim said, "Let me go over," the men of Gilead said to him, "Are you an Ephraimite?" When he said, "No,"
- 6 *Then said they unto him, Say now Shibboleth: and he said Sibboleth: for he could not frame to pronounce it right. Then they took him, and slew him at the passages of Jordan: and there fell at that time of the Ephraimites forty and two thousand.* they said to him, "Then say Shibboleth," and he said, "Sibboleth," for he could not pronounce it right. Then they seized him and slaughtered him at the fords of the Jordan. At that time 42,000 of the Ephraimites fell.
- 7 *And Jephthah judged Israel six years. Then died Jephthah the Gileadite, and was buried in one of the cities of Gilead.* Jephthah judged Israel six years. Then Jephthah the Gileadite died and was buried in his city in Gilead.
- 8 *And after him Ibzan of Bethlehem judged Israel.* After him Ibzan of Bethlehem judged Israel.
- 9 *And he had thirty sons, and thirty daughters, whom he sent abroad, and took in thirty daughters from abroad for his sons. And he judged Israel seven years.* He had thirty sons, and thirty daughters he gave in marriage outside his clan, and thirty daughters he brought in from outside for his sons. And he judged Israel seven years.
- 10 *Then died Ibzan, and was buried at Bethlehem.* Then Ibzan died and was buried at Bethlehem.
- 11 *And after him Elon, a Zebulonite, judged Israel; and he judged Israel ten years.* After him Elon the Zebulonite judged Israel. He judged Israel ten years.
- 12 *And Elon the Zebulonite died, and was buried in Aijalon in the country of Zebulun.* Then Elon the Zebulonite died and was buried at Aijalon in the land of Zebulun.

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| 13 | <i>And after him Abdon the son of Hillel, a Pirathonite, judged Israel.</i> | After him Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite judged Israel. |
| 14 | <i>And he had forty sons and thirty nephews, that rode on threescore and ten ass colts: and he judged Israel eight years.</i> | He had forty sons and thirty grandsons, who rode on seventy donkeys. He judged Israel eight years. |
| 15 | <i>And Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite died, and was buried in Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the mount of the Amalekites.</i> | Then Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite died and was buried at Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the hill country of the Amalekites. |

Words in this chapter:

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

v1 — Judg 8:1

v3 — 1 Sam 28:21; Job 13:14; 1 Sam 19:5; Ps 119:109

v5 — Judg 3:28

Chapter 13

Israel was given into the hand of the Philistines for forty years, and the angel of the LORD appeared to the wife of Manoah, announcing she would bear a Nazirite son. The child was born and named Samson, and the Spirit of the LORD began to stir him.

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| 1 | <i>And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD; and the LORD delivered them into the hand of the Philistines forty years.</i> | the people of Israel again did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, so the LORD gave them into the hand of the Philistines for forty years. |
| 2 | <i>And there was a certain man of Zorah, of the family of the Danites, whose name was Manoah; and his wife was barren, and bare not.</i> | There was a certain man of Zorah, of the tribe of the Danites, whose name was Manoah. And his wife was barren and had no children. |

- 3 *And the angel of the LORD appeared unto the woman, and said unto her, Behold now, thou art barren, and bearest not: but thou shalt conceive, and bear a son.* the angel of the LORD appeared to the woman and said to her, " you are barren and have not borne children, but You shall conceive and bear a son.
- 4 *Now therefore beware, I pray thee, and drink not wine nor strong drink, and eat not any unclean thing:* Therefore be careful and drink no wine or strong drink, and eat nothing unclean,
- 5 *For, lo, thou shalt conceive, and bear a son; and no razor shall come on his head: for the child shall be a Nazarite unto God from the womb: and he shall begin to deliver Israel out of the hand of the Philistines.* for You shall conceive and bear a son. No razor shall come upon His head, for the child shall be a Nazarite to God from the womb. He shall begin to save Israel from the hand of the Philistines."
- 6 *Then the woman came and told her husband, saying, A man of God came unto me, and his countenance was like the countenance of an angel of God, very terrible: but I asked him not whence he was, neither told he me his name:* Then the woman came and told her husband, "A man of God came to me. His appearance was like the appearance of the angel of God, very awesome. I did not ask Him where He was from. He did not tell me His name.
- 7 *But he said unto me, Behold, thou shalt conceive, and bear a son; and now drink no wine nor strong drink, neither eat any unclean thing: for the child shall be a Nazarite to God from the womb to the day of his death.* But he said to me, ' you shall conceive and bear a son. So then drink no wine or strong drink, and eat nothing unclean, for the child shall be a Nazarite to God from the womb to the day of His death.' "
- 8 *Then Manoah intreated the LORD, and said, O my Lord, let the man of God which thou didst send come again unto us, and teach us what we shall do unto the child that shall be born.* Then Manoah prayed to the LORD and said, "O Lord, please let the man of God whom You sent come again to us and teach us what we are to do with the child who will be born."

- 9 *And God hearkened to the voice of Manoah; and the angel of God came again unto the woman as she sat in the field: but Manoah her husband was not with her.* God listened to the voice of Manoah, and the angel of God came again to the woman as she sat in the field. But Manoah her husband was not with her.
- 10 *And the woman made haste, and ran, and shewed her husband, and said unto him, Behold, the man hath appeared unto me, that came unto me the other day.* So the woman ran quickly and told her husband, " the man who came to me the other day has appeared to me."
- 11 *And Manoah arose, and went after his wife, and came to the man, and said unto him, Art thou the man that spakest unto the woman? And he said, I am.* Manoah arose and went after his wife and came to the man and said to him, "Are you the man who spoke to this woman?" And he said, "I am."
- 12 *And Manoah said, Now let thy words come to pass. How shall we order the child, and how shall we do unto him?* Manoah said, "Now when your words come true, what is to be the child's manner of life, and what is his mission?"
- 13 *And the angel of the LORD said unto Manoah, Of all that I said unto the woman let her beware.* the angel of the LORD said to Manoah, "Of all that I said to the woman let her be careful.
- 14 *She may not eat of any thing that cometh of the vine, neither let her drink wine or strong drink, nor eat any unclean thing: all that I commanded her let her observe.* She may not eat of anything that comes from the vine, neither let her drink wine or strong drink, or eat any unclean thing. All that I commanded her let her observe."
- 15 *And Manoah said unto the angel of the LORD, I pray thee, let us detain thee, until we shall have made ready a kid for thee.* Manoah said to the angel of the LORD, "Please let us detain You and prepare a young goat for You."

- 16 *And the angel of the LORD said unto Manoah, Though thou detain me, I will not eat of thy bread: and if thou wilt offer a burnt offering, thou must offer it unto the LORD. For Manoah knew not that he was an angel of the LORD.* the angel of the LORD said to Manoah, "If You detain me, I will not eat of Your food. But if You prepare a burnt offering, then offer it to the LORD." (For Manoah did not know that He was the angel of the LORD.)
- 17 *And Manoah said unto the angel of the LORD, What is thy name, that when thy sayings come to pass we may do thee honour?* Manoah said to the angel of the LORD, "What is Your name, so that, when Your words come true, we may honor You?"
- 18 *And the angel of the LORD said unto him, Why askest thou thus after my name, seeing it is secret?* the angel of the LORD said to Him, "Why do You ask my name, seeing it is wonderful?"
- 19 *So Manoah took a kid with a meat offering, and offered it upon a rock unto the LORD: and the angel did wondrously; and Manoah and his wife looked on.* So Manoah took the young goat with the grain offering, and offered it on the rock to the LORD, to the one who works wonders, and Manoah and his wife were watching.
- 20 *For it came to pass, when the flame went up toward heaven from off the altar, that the angel of the LORD ascended in the flame of the altar. And Manoah and his wife looked on it, and fell on their faces to the ground.* when the flame went up toward heaven from the altar, the angel of the LORD went up in the flame of the altar. Now Manoah and his wife were watching. They fell on their faces to the ground.
- 21 *But the angel of the LORD did no more appear to Manoah and to his wife. Then Manoah knew that he was an angel of the LORD.* The angel of the LORD appeared no more to Manoah and to his wife. Then Manoah knew that He was the angel of the LORD.
- 22 *And Manoah said unto his wife, We shall surely die, because we have seen God.* Manoah said to his wife, "We shall surely die, for we have seen God."

- 23 *But his wife said unto him, If the LORD were pleased to kill us, he would not have received a burnt offering and a meat offering at our hands, neither would he have shewed us all these things, nor would as at this time have told us such things as these.* But his wife said to Him, "If the LORD had meant to kill us, He would not have accepted a burnt offering and a grain offering at our hands, or shown us all these things, or now announced to us such things as these."
- 24 *And the woman bare a son, and called his name Samson: and the child grew, and the LORD blessed him.* the woman bore a son and called his name Samson. And the young man grew. The LORD blessed Him.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Samson** (SAM-sun) — "man of the sun" — A Nazirite from birth, of the tribe of Dan, endowed with supernatural strength by the Spirit of the LORD. He judged Israel twenty years, fought the Philistines single-handedly, but was undone by Delilah. In his death he destroyed more Philistines than in his life.
- 25 *And the Spirit of the LORD began to move him at times in the camp of Dan between Zorah and Eshtaol.* the Spirit of the LORD began to stir Him in the camp of Dan, between Zorah and Eshtaol.

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Samson (SAM-son) — A judge with supernatural strength given by God — his power was tied to his uncut hair as a Nazirite; betrayed by Delilah and captured by the Philistines.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Sam 12:9; Judg 6:1; Rom 2:6
v2 — Josh 19:41; Josh 15:33; Gen 25:21; Luke 1:7; 1 Sam 1:2-6
v3 — Luke 1:13; Luke 1:11; Gen 18:10; 2 Kgs 4:16; Judg 13:8
v4 — Luke 1:15; Judg 13:14; Num 6:2-3
v5 — Num 6:5; 1 Sam 1:11; Num 6:2-3; 1 Chr 18:1; 1 Sam 7:13
v6 — Judg 13:17-18; Matt 28:3-4; 1 Sam 9:6; Rev 1:17; Luke 9:29
v8 — Acts 9:6
v18 — Gen 32:29; Isa 9:6
v20 — Lev 9:24; 1 Chr 21:16; 2 Kgs 2:11
v22 — Gen 32:30; Deut 5:26; John 1:18; Ex 33:20; John 5:37
v23 — Ps 25:14; 1 Cor 12:21
v24 — Luke 1:80; 1 Sam 3:19; Heb 11:32; Luke 2:52

Chapter 14

Samson demanded a Philistine woman of Timnah as his wife, and on the way he killed a lion with his bare hands. At the wedding feast he posed a riddle; when his wife betrayed the answer, Samson struck down thirty men of Ashkelon to pay the wager.

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| 1 <i>And Samson went down to Timnath, and saw a woman in Timnath of the daughters of the Philistines.</i> | Samson went down to Timnath, and at Timnath he saw one of the daughters of the Philistines. |
| 2 <i>And he came up, and told his father and his mother, and said, I have seen a woman in Timnath of the daughters of the Philistines: now therefore get her for me to wife.</i> | Then he came up and told his father and mother, "I saw one of the daughters of the Philistines at Timnath. Now get her for me as my wife." |
| 3 <i>Then his father and his mother said unto him, Is there never a woman among the daughters of thy brethren, or among all my people, that thou goest to take a wife of the uncircumcised Philistines? And Samson said unto his father, Get her for me; for she pleaseth me well.</i> | But his father and mother said to him, "Is there not a woman among the daughters of your relatives, or among all our people, that you must go to take a wife from the uncircumcised Philistines?" But Samson said to his father, "Get her for me, for she is right in my eyes." |
| 4 <i>But his father and his mother knew not that it was of the LORD, that he sought an occasion against the Philistines: for at that time the Philistines had dominion over Israel.</i> | His father and mother did not know that it was from the LORD, for He was seeking an opportunity against the Philistines. At that time the Philistines ruled over Israel. |
| 5 <i>Then went Samson down, and his father and his mother, to Timnath, and came to the vineyards of Timnath: and, behold, a young lion roared against him.</i> | Then Samson went down with his father and mother to Timnath. They came to the vineyards of Timnath. And a young lion came toward him roaring. |

- 6 *And the Spirit of the LORD came mightily upon him, and he rent him as he would have rent a kid, and he had nothing in his hand: but he told not his father or his mother what he had done.* Then the Spirit of the LORD rushed upon Him, and although He had nothing in His hand, He tore the lion in pieces as one tears a young goat. But He did not tell His father or His mother what He had done.
- 7 *And he went down, and talked with the woman; and she pleased Samson well.* Then he went down and talked with the woman. She was right in Samson's eyes.
- 8 *And after a time he returned to take her, and he turned aside to see the carcase of the lion: and, behold, there was a swarm of bees and honey in the carcase of the lion.* After some days he returned to take her. And he turned aside to see the carcass of the lion, and there was a swarm of bees in the body of the lion, and honey.
- 9 *And he took thereof in his hands, and went on eating, and came to his father and mother, and he gave them, and they did eat: but he told not them that he had taken the honey out of the carcase of the lion.* He scraped it out into his hands and went on, eating as he went. And he came to his father and mother and gave some to them. They ate. But he did not tell them that he had scraped the honey from the carcass of the lion.
- 10 *So his father went down unto the woman: and Samson made there a feast; for so used the young men to do.* His father went down to the woman, and Samson prepared a feast there, for so the young men used to do.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when they saw him, that they brought thirty companions to be with him.* As soon as the people saw him, they brought thirty companions to be with him.
- 12 *And Samson said unto them, I will now put forth a riddle unto you: if ye can certainly declare it me within the seven days of the feast, and find it out, then I will give you thirty sheets and thirty change of garments:* Samson said to them, "Let me now put a riddle to you. If you can tell me what it is within the seven days of the feast, and find it out, then I will give you thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothes,

- 13 *But if ye cannot declare it me, then shall ye give me thirty sheets and thirty change of garments. And they said unto him, Put forth thy riddle, that we may hear it.* but if you cannot tell me what it is, then you shall give me thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothes." And they said to him, "Put your riddle, that we may hear it."
- 14 *And he said unto them, Out of the eater came forth meat, and out of the strong came forth sweetness. And they could not in three days expound the riddle.* he said to them, "Out of the eater came something to eat. Out of the strong came something sweet." And in three days they could not solve the riddle.
- 15 *And it came to pass on the seventh day, that they said unto Samson's wife, Entice thy husband, that he may declare unto us the riddle, lest we burn thee and thy father's house with fire: have ye called us to take that we have? is it not so?* On the seventh day they said to Samson's wife, "Entice your husband to tell us what the riddle is, or we will burn you and your father's house with fire. Have you invited us here to impoverish us?"
- 16 *And Samson's wife wept before him, and said, Thou dost but hate me, and lovest me not: thou hast put forth a riddle unto the children of my people, and hast not told it me. And he said unto her, Behold, I have not told it my father nor my mother, and shall I tell it thee?* Samson's wife wept over him and said, "You only hate me; you do not love me. You have put a riddle to my people, and you have not told me what it is." And he said to her, "I have not told my father nor my mother, and shall I tell you?"
- 17 *And she wept before him the seven days, while their feast lasted: and it came to pass on the seventh day, that he told her, because she lay sore upon him: and she told the riddle to the children of her people.* She wept before him the seven days that their feast lasted, and on the seventh day he told her, because she pressed him hard. Then she told the riddle to her people.

- 18 *And the men of the city said unto him on the seventh day before the sun went down, What is sweeter than honey? and what is stronger than a lion? And he said unto them, If ye had not plowed with my heifer, ye had not found out my riddle.* the men of the city said to him on the seventh day before the sun went down, "What is sweeter than honey? What is stronger than a lion?" And he said to them, "If you had not plowed with my heifer, you would not have found out my riddle."
- 19 *And the Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he went down to Ashkelon, and slew thirty men of them, and took their spoil, and gave change of garments unto them which expounded the riddle. And his anger was kindled, and he went up to his father's house.* the Spirit of the LORD rushed upon Him. He went down to Ashkelon and struck down thirty men of the town and took their spoil and gave the garments to those who had told the riddle. In hot anger He went back to His father's house.
- 20 *But Samson's wife was given to his companion, whom he had used as his friend.* Samson's wife was given to his companion, who had been his best man.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Samson (*SAM-son*) — A judge with supernatural strength given by God — his power was tied to his uncut hair as a Nazirite; betrayed by Delilah and captured by the Philistines.

Cross-References:

v2 — Gen 34:4

v4 — Josh 11:20; Ps 115:3

v6 — Judg 3:10; Zech 4:6; Judg 13:25

v12 — 1 Kgs 10:1; Gen 45:22; Ezek 17:2

v15 — Judg 15:6; Judg 16:5

v16 — Judg 16:15

v19 — Judg 3:10; 1 Sam 11:6

v20 — Judg 15:2

Chapter 15

Samson burned the Philistines' grain fields with foxes and torches after his wife was given to another man. The Philistines retaliated, and Samson struck down a thousand men with the jawbone of a donkey at Lehi.

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| <p>1 <i>But it came to pass within a while after, in the time of wheat harvest, that Samson visited his wife with a kid; and he said, I will go in to my wife into the chamber. But her father would not suffer him to go in.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And her father said, I verily thought that thou hadst utterly hated her; therefore I gave her to thy companion: is not her younger sister fairer than she? take her, I pray thee, instead of her.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And Samson said concerning them, Now shall I be more blameless than the Philistines, though I do them a displeasure.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And Samson went and caught three hundred foxes, and took firebrands, and turned tail to tail, and put a firebrand in the midst between two tails.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And when he had set the brands on fire, he let them go into the standing corn of the Philistines, and burnt up both the shocks, and also the standing corn, with the vineyards and olives.</i></p> | <p>After some days, at the time of wheat harvest, Samson went to visit his wife with a young goat. And he said, "I will go in to my wife in the chamber." But her father would not allow him to go in.</p> <p>her father said, "I really thought that you utterly hated her, so I gave her to your companion. Is not her younger sister more beautiful than she? Please take her instead."</p> <p>Samson said to them, "This time I shall be innocent in regard to the Philistines, when I do them harm."</p> <p>So Samson went and caught 300 foxes and took torches. And he turned them tail to tail and put a torch between each pair of tails.</p> <p>when he had set fire to the torches, he let the foxes go into the standing grain of the Philistines and set fire to the stacked grain and the standing grain, as well as the olive orchards.</p> |
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- 6 *Then the Philistines said, Who hath done this? And they answered, Samson, the son in law of the Timnite, because he had taken his wife, and given her to his companion. And the Philistines came up, and burnt her and her father with fire.* Then the Philistines said, "Who has done this?" And they said, "Samson, the son-in-law of the Timnite, because he has taken his wife and given her to his companion." And the Philistines came up and burned her and her father with fire.
- 7 *And Samson said unto them, Though ye have done this, yet will I be avenged of you, and after that I will cease.* Samson said to them, "If this is what you do, I swear I will be avenged on you, and after that I will quit."
- 8 *And he smote them hip and thigh with a great slaughter: and he went down and dwelt in the top of the rock Etam.* he struck them hip and thigh with a great blow. He went down and stayed in the cleft of the rock of Etam.
- 9 *Then the Philistines went up, and pitched in Judah, and spread themselves in Lehi.* Then the Philistines came up and encamped in Judah and made a raid on Lehi.
- 10 *And the men of Judah said, Why are ye come up against us? And they answered, To bind Samson are we come up, to do to him as he hath done to us.* the men of Judah said, "Why have you come up against us?" They said, "We have come up to bind Samson, to do to him as he did to us."
- 11 *Then three thousand men of Judah went to the top of the rock Etam, and said to Samson, Knowest thou not that the Philistines are rulers over us? what is this that thou hast done unto us? And he said unto them, As they did unto me, so have I done unto them.* Then 3,000 men of Judah went down to the cleft of the rock of Etam, and said to Samson, "Do you not know that the Philistines are rulers over us? What then is this that you have done to us?" And he said to them, "As they did to me, so have I done to them."

- 12 *And they said unto him, We are come down to bind thee, that we may deliver thee into the hand of the Philistines. And Samson said unto them, Swear unto me, that ye will not fall upon me yourselves.* they said to him, "We have come down to bind you, that we may give you into the hands of the Philistines." And Samson said to them, "Swear to me that you will not attack me yourselves."
- 13 *And they spake unto him, saying, No; but we will bind thee fast, and deliver thee into their hand: but surely we will not kill thee. And they bound him with two new cords, and brought him up from the rock.* They said to him, "No; we will only bind you and give you into their hands. We will surely not kill you." So they bound him with two new ropes and brought him up from the rock.
- 14 *And when he came unto Lehi, the Philistines shouted against him: and the Spirit of the LORD came mightily upon him, and the cords that were upon his arms became as flax that was burnt with fire, and his bands loosed from off his hands.* When He came to Lehi, the Philistines came shouting to meet Him. Then the Spirit of the LORD rushed upon Him, and the ropes that were on His arms became as flax that has caught fire. His bonds melted off His hands.
- 15 *And he found a new jawbone of an ass, and put forth his hand, and took it, and slew a thousand men therewith.* he found a fresh jawbone of a donkey, and put out His hand and took it, and with it He struck 1,000 men.
- 16 *And Samson said, With the jawbone of an ass, heaps upon heaps, with the jaw of an ass have I slain a thousand men.* Samson said, "With the jawbone of a donkey, heaps upon heaps, with the jawbone of a donkey have I struck down a thousand men."
- 17 *And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking, that he cast away the jawbone out of his hand, and called that place Ramathlehi.* As soon as he had finished speaking, he threw away the jawbone out of his hand. And that place was called Ramathlehi.

- 18 *And he was sore athirst, and called on the LORD, and said, Thou hast given this great deliverance into the hand of thy servant: and now shall I die for thirst, and fall into the hand of the uncircumcised?* he was very thirsty. He called upon the LORD and said, "You have granted this great salvation by the hand of Your servant, and shall I now die of thirst and fall into the hands of the uncircumcised?"
- 19 *But God clave an hollow place that was in the jaw, and there came water thereout; and when he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived: wherefore he called the name thereof Enhakkore, which is in Lehi unto this day.* God split open the hollow place that is at Lehi, and water came out from it. And when He drank, His spirit returned. He revived. Therefore the name of it was called Enhakkore; it is at Lehi to this day.
- 20 *And he judged Israel in the days of the Philistines twenty years.* he judged Israel in the days of the Philistines twenty years.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 38:17
v2 — Judg 14:20
v6 — Judg 14:15
v11 — Judg 14:4; Judg 13:1
v15 — Lev 26:8; Josh 23:10; Judg 3:31; 1 Sam 17:49-50; 1 Cor 1:27-28
v19 — Isa 44:3; Gen 45:27
v20 — Judg 13:1

Chapter 16

Samson loved Delilah, who pressed him until he revealed that his strength lay in his Nazirite vow and his uncut hair. The Philistines shaved his head, gouged out his eyes, and imprisoned him, but his hair grew back and he pulled down the temple of Dagon, killing more in his death than in his life.

- 1 *Then went Samson to Gaza, and saw there an harlot, and went in unto her.* Samson went to Gaza, and there he saw a prostitute. He went in to her.

- 2 *And it was told the Gazites, saying, Samson is come hither. And they compassed him in, and laid wait for him all night in the gate of the city, and were quiet all the night, saying, In the morning, when it is day, we shall kill him.* The Gazites were told, "Samson has come here." And they surrounded the place and set an ambush for him all night at the gate of the city. They kept quiet all night, saying, "Let us wait till the light of the morning; then we will kill him."
- 3 *And Samson lay till midnight, and arose at midnight, and took the doors of the gate of the city, and the two posts, and went away with them, bar and all, and put them upon his shoulders, and carried them up to the top of an hill that is before Hebron.* But Samson lay till midnight, and at midnight he arose and took hold of the doors of the gate of the city and the two posts, and pulled them up, bar and all, and put them on his shoulders and carried them to the top of the hill that is in front of Hebron.
- 4 *And it came to pass afterward, that he loved a woman in the valley of Sorek, whose name was Delilah.* After this he loved a woman in the Valley of Sorek, whose name was Delilah.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Delilah** (deh-LY-lah) — "delicate, languishing" — A woman of the Valley of Sorek whom the Philistine lords bribed with 1,100 pieces of silver each to discover the secret of Samson's strength. Through persistent nagging she broke him down and betrayed him to his enemies.

- 5 *And the lords of the Philistines came up unto her, and said unto her, Entice him, and see wherein his great strength lieth, and by what means we may prevail against him, that we may bind him to afflict him: and we will give thee every one of us eleven hundred pieces of silver.* the lords of the Philistines came up to her and said to her, "Seduce him, and see where his great strength lies, and by what means we may overpower him, that we may bind him to humble him. And we will each give you 1,100 pieces of silver."
- 6 *And Delilah said to Samson, Tell me, I pray thee, wherein thy great strength lieth, and wherewith thou mightest be bound to afflict thee.* So Delilah said to Samson, "Please tell me where your great strength lies, and how you might be bound, that one could subdue you."

- 7 *And Samson said unto her, If they bind me with seven green withs that were never dried, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.* Samson said to her, "If they bind me with seven fresh bowstrings that have not been dried, then I shall become weak and be like any other man."
- 8 *Then the lords of the Philistines brought up to her seven green withs which had not been dried, and she bound him with them.* Then the lords of the Philistines brought her seven fresh bowstrings that had not been dried. She bound him with them.
- 9 *Now there were men lying in wait, abiding with her in the chamber. And she said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he brake the withs, as a thread of tow is broken when it toucheth the fire. So his strength was not known.* Now she had men lying in ambush in an inner chamber. And she said to him, "The Philistines are upon you, Samson!" But he snapped the bowstrings, as a thread of flax snaps when it touches the fire. So the secret of his strength was not known.
- 10 *And Delilah said unto Samson, Behold, thou hast mocked me, and told me lies: now tell me, I pray thee, wherewith thou mightest be bound.* Then Delilah said to Samson, " you have mocked me and told me lies. Please tell me how you might be bound."
- 11 *And he said unto her, If they bind me fast with new ropes that never were occupied, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.* he said to her, "If they bind me with new ropes that have not been used, then I shall become weak and be like any other man."
- 12 *Delilah therefore took new ropes, and bound him therewith, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And there were liers in wait abiding in the chamber. And he brake them from off his arms like a thread.* So Delilah took new ropes and bound him with them and said to him, "The Philistines are upon you, Samson!" And the men lying in ambush were in an inner chamber. But he snapped the ropes off his arms like a thread.

- 13 *And Delilah said unto Samson, Hitherto thou hast mocked me, and told me lies: tell me wherewith thou mightest be bound. And he said unto her, If thou weavest the seven locks of my head with the web.* Then Delilah said to Samson, "Until now you have mocked me and told me lies. Tell me how you might be bound." And he said to her, "If you weave the seven locks of my head with the web and fasten it tight with the pin, then I shall become weak and be like any other man."
- 14 *And she fastened it with the pin, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he awaked out of his sleep, and went away with the pin of the beam, and with the web.* So while he slept, Delilah took the seven locks of his head and wove them into the web. And she made them tight with the pin and said to him, "The Philistines are upon you, Samson!" But he awoke from his sleep and pulled away the pin, the loom, and the web.
- 15 *And she said unto him, How canst thou say, I love thee, when thine heart is not with me? thou hast mocked me these three times, and hast not told me wherein thy great strength lieth.* she said to him, "How can you say, 'I love you,' when your heart is not with me? You have mocked me these three times, and you have not told me where your great strength lies."
- 16 *And it came to pass, when she pressed him daily with her words, and urged him, so that his soul was vexed unto death;* when she pressed him hard with her words day after day, and urged him, his soul was vexed to death.
- 17 *That he told her all his heart, and said unto her, There hath not come a razor upon mine head; for I have been a Nazarite unto God from my mother's womb: if I be shaven, then my strength will go from me, and I shall become weak, and be like any other man.* he told her all his heart, and said to her, "A razor has never come upon my head, for I have been a Nazarite to God from my mother's womb. If my head is shaved, then my strength will leave me. I shall become weak and be like any other man."

- 18 *And when Delilah saw that he had told her all his heart, she sent and called for the lords of the Philistines, saying, Come up this once, for he hath shewed me all his heart. Then the lords of the Philistines came up unto her, and brought money in their hand.* When Delilah saw that he had told her all his heart, she sent and called the lords of the Philistines, saying, "Come up again, for he has told me all his heart." Then the lords of the Philistines came up to her and brought the money in their hands.
- 19 *And she made him sleep upon her knees; and she called for a man, and she caused him to shave off the seven locks of his head; and she began to afflict him, and his strength went from him.* She made him sleep on her knees. And she called a man and had him shave off the seven locks of his head. Then she began to torment him. His strength left him.
- 20 *And she said, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he awoke out of his sleep, and said, I will go out as at other times before, and shake myself. And he wist not that the LORD was departed from him.* she said, "The Philistines are upon You, Samson!" And he awoke from his sleep and said, "I will go out as at other times and shake myself free." But He did not know that the LORD had left Him.
- 21 *But the Philistines took him, and put out his eyes, and brought him down to Gaza, and bound him with fetters of brass; and he did grind in the prison house.* the Philistines seized Him and gouged out His eyes and brought Him down to Gaza and bound Him with bronze shackles. And He ground at the mill in the prison.
- 22 *Howbeit the hair of his head began to grow again after he was shaven.* But the hair of His head began to grow again after it had been shaved.
- 23 *Then the lords of the Philistines gathered them together for to offer a great sacrifice unto Dagon their god, and to rejoice: for they said, Our god hath delivered Samson our enemy into our hand.* Now the lords of the Philistines gathered to offer a great sacrifice to Dagon their god and to rejoice. They said, "Our god has given Samson our enemy into our hand."

- 24 *And when the people saw him, they praised their god: for they said, Our god hath delivered into our hands our enemy, and the destroyer of our country, which slew many of us.* when the people saw him, they praised their god. For they said, "Our god has given our enemy into our hand, the ravager of our country, who has killed many of us."
- 25 *And it came to pass, when their hearts were merry, that they said, Call for Samson, that he may make us sport. And they called for Samson out of the prison house; and he made them sport: and they set him between the pillars.* when their hearts were merry, they said, "Call Samson, that he may entertain us." So they called Samson out of the prison. He entertained them. They made him stand between the pillars.
- 26 *And Samson said unto the lad that held him by the hand, Suffer me that I may feel the pillars whereupon the house standeth, that I may lean upon them.* Samson said to the young man who held him by the hand, "Let me feel the pillars on which the house rests, that I may lean against them."
- 27 *Now the house was full of men and women; and all the lords of the Philistines were there; and there were upon the roof about three thousand men and women, that beheld while Samson made sport.* Now the house was full of men and women. All the lords of the Philistines were there, and on the roof there were about 3,000 men and women, who looked on while Samson entertained.
- 28 *And Samson called unto the LORD, and said, O Lord GOD, remember me, I pray thee, and strengthen me, I pray thee, only this once, O God, that I may be at once avenged of the Philistines for my two eyes.* Then Samson called to the LORD and said, "O Lord GOD, please remember me and please strengthen me only this once, O God, that I may be avenged on the Philistines for my two eyes."
- 29 *And Samson took hold of the two middle pillars upon which the house stood, and on which it was borne up, of the one with his right hand, and of the other with his left.* Samson grasped the two middle pillars on which the house rested. He leaned his weight against them, his right hand on the one and his left hand on the other.

- 30 *And Samson said, Let me die with the Philistines. And he bowed himself with all his might; and the house fell upon the lords, and upon all the people that were therein. So the dead which he slew at his death were more than they which he slew in his life.* Samson said, "Let me die with the Philistines." Then he bowed with all his strength, and the house fell upon the lords and upon all the people who were in it. So the dead whom he killed at his death were more than those he had killed during his life.
- 31 *Then his brethren and all the house of his father came down, and took him, and brought him up, and buried him between Zorah and Eshtaol in the buryingplace of Manoah his father. And he had judged Israel twenty years.* Then his brothers and all his family came down and took him and brought him up and buried him between Zorah and Eshtaol in the tomb of Manoah his father. He had judged Israel twenty years.

Words in this chapter:

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 118:10-12; 1 Sam 23:26
 v5 — Judg 14:15; Josh 13:3
 v15 — Judg 14:16
 v16 — Prov 7:21-23
 v17 — Mic 7:5; Prov 12:23; Judg 13:5; Num 6:5
 v20 — Num 14:42-43; 1 Sam 16:14; Josh 7:12; 1 Sam 18:12; 2 Chr 15:2
 v21 — Prov 2:19; Prov 14:14
 v22 — Lev 26:44; Ps 106:44-45; Ps 107:13-14; Deut 32:36
 v27 — Deut 22:8
 v28 — Jer 15:15; Lam 3:31-32; Rev 6:10; Ps 91:15; Ps 143:12

Chapter 17

A man named Micah in the hill country of Ephraim set up a shrine with a carved image, an ephod, and household gods, and hired a wandering Levite as his personal priest. The refrain declares that in those days there was no king in Israel, and every man did what was right in his own eyes.

- 1 *And there was a man of mount Ephraim, whose name was Micah.* There was a man of the hill country of Ephraim, whose name was Micah.

- 2 *And he said unto his mother, The eleven hundred shekels of silver that were taken from thee, about which thou cursedst, and spakest of also in mine ears, behold, the silver is with me; I took it. And his mother said, Blessed be thou of the LORD, my son.* he said to His mother, "The 1,100 pieces of silver that were taken from You, about which You uttered a curse, and also spoke it in my ears—the silver is with me; I took it." And His mother said, "Blessed be my son by the LORD."
- 3 *And when he had restored the eleven hundred shekels of silver to his mother, his mother said, I had wholly dedicated the silver unto the LORD from my hand for my son, to make a graven image and a molten image: now therefore I will restore it unto thee.* he restored the 1,100 pieces of silver to His mother. And His mother said, "I dedicate the silver to the LORD from my hand for my son, to make a graven image and a molten image. Now therefore I will restore it to You."
- 4 *Yet he restored the money unto his mother; and his mother took two hundred shekels of silver, and gave them to the founder, who made thereof a graven image and a molten image: and they were in the house of Micah.* So when He restored the money to His mother, His mother took 200 pieces of silver and gave it to the silversmith, who made it into a graven image and a molten image. And it was in the house of Micah.
- 5 *And the man Micah had an house of gods, and made an ephod, and teraphim, and consecrated one of his sons, who became his priest.* the man Micah had a shrine. He made an ephod and household gods, and ordained one of his sons, who became his priest.
- 6 *In those days there was no king in Israel, but every man did that which was right in his own eyes.* In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did what was right in his own eyes.
- 7 *And there was a young man out of Bethlehemjudah of the family of Judah, who was a Levite, and he sojourned there.* Now there was a young man of Bethlehemjudah, of the family of Judah, who was a Levite. He stayed there.

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| <p>8 <i>And the man departed out of the city from Bethlehemjudah to sojourn where he could find a place: and he came to mount Ephraim to the house of Micah, as he journeyed.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Micah said unto him, Whence comest thou? And he said unto him, I am a Levite of Bethlehemjudah, and I go to sojourn where I may find a place.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Micah said unto him, Dwell with me, and be unto me a father and a priest, and I will give thee ten shekels of silver by the year, and a suit of apparel, and thy victuals. So the Levite went in.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And the Levite was content to dwell with the man; and the young man was unto him as one of his sons.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Micah consecrated the Levite; and the young man became his priest, and was in the house of Micah.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Then said Micah, Now know I that the LORD will do me good, seeing I have a Levite to my priest.</i></p> | <p>the man departed from the town of Bethlehemjudah to stay where he could find a place. And as he journeyed, he came to the hill country of Ephraim to the house of Micah.</p> <p>Micah said to him, "Where do you come from?" And he said to him, "I am a Levite of Bethlehemjudah. I am going to stay where I may find a place."</p> <p>Micah said to him, "Stay with me, and be to me a father and a priest. I will give you ten pieces of silver a year and a suit of clothes and your living." And the Levite went in.</p> <p>the Levite was content to dwell with the man, and the young man became to him like one of his sons.</p> <p>Micah ordained the Levite, and the young man became his priest, and was in the house of Micah.</p> <p>Then Micah said, "Now I know that the LORD will prosper me, because I have a Levite as priest."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

teraphim (*TEHR-ah-fim*) — Household idols used for divination — Rachel stole her father Laban's teraphim; Micah in Judges had teraphim; they represent false worship.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Neh 13:25
v3 — Lev 19:4; Ex 20:4
v5 — Gen 31:30; Gen 31:19; Judg 18:14; Judg 8:27
v6 — Deut 12:8; Prov 14:12; Prov 12:15; Judg 21:25; Judg 18:1
v7 — Ruth 1:1-2; Matt 2:1; Mic 5:2

Chapter 18

The tribe of Dan sent five spies who discovered Micah's shrine and its Levite priest. Six hundred armed Danites stole the idols and took the priest for themselves, conquering the city of Laish and renaming it Dan.

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| 1 | <i>In those days there was no king in Israel: and in those days the tribe of the Danites sought them an inheritance to dwell in; for unto that day all their inheritance had not fallen unto them among the tribes of Israel.</i> | In those days there was no king in Israel. And in those days the tribe of the people of Dan was seeking for itself an inheritance to dwell in, for until then no inheritance among the tribes of Israel had fallen to them. |
| 2 | <i>And the children of Dan sent of their family five men from their coasts, men of valour, from Zorah, and from Eshtaol, to spy out the land, and to search it; and they said unto them, Go, search the land: who when they came to mount Ephraim, to the house of Micah, they lodged there.</i> | So the people of Dan sent five able men from the whole number of their tribe, from Zorah and from Eshtaol, to spy out the land and to explore it. And they said to them, "Go and explore the land." And they came to the hill country of Ephraim, to the house of Micah, and lodged there. |
| 3 | <i>When they were by the house of Micah, they knew the voice of the young man the Levite: and they turned in thither, and said unto him, Who brought thee hither? and what makest thou in this place? and what hast thou here?</i> | When they were by the house of Micah, they recognized the voice of the young man, the Levite. They turned aside there and said to him, "Who brought you here? What are you doing in this place? What is your business here?" |
| 4 | <i>And he said unto them, Thus and thus dealeth Micah with me, and hath hired me, and I am his priest.</i> | He said to them, "This is how Micah deals with me: he has hired me, and I am his priest." |
| 5 | <i>And they said unto him, Ask counsel, we pray thee, of God, that we may know whether our way which we go shall be prosperous.</i> | They said to him, "Inquire of God, we pray, that we may know whether the journey on which we are going will be prosperous." |

- 6 *And the priest said unto them, Go in peace: before the LORD is your way wherein ye go.* the priest said to them, "Go in peace. The way in which You go is before the LORD."
- 7 *Then the five men departed, and came to Laish, and saw the people that were therein, how they dwelt careless, after the manner of the Zidonians, quiet and secure; and there was no magistrate in the land, that might put them to shame in any thing; and they were far from the Zidonians, and had no business with any man.* Then the five men departed and came to Laish and saw the people who were there, how they lived in security, after the manner of the Sidonians, quiet and unsuspecting, lacking nothing that is in the earth and possessing wealth, and how they were far from the Sidonians and had no dealings with anyone.
- 8 *And they came unto their brethren to Zorah and Eshtaol: and their brethren said unto them, What say ye?* Then they came to their brothers at Zorah and Eshtaol, and their brothers said to them, "What do You report?"
- 9 *And they said, Arise, that we may go up against them: for we have seen the land, and, behold, it is very good: and are ye still? be not slothful to go, and to enter to possess the land.* They said, "Arise, and let us go up against them, for we have seen the land, and it is very good. Will You do nothing? Do not be slow to go and enter in to possess the land.
- 10 *When ye go, ye shall come unto a people secure, and to a large land: for God hath given it into your hands; a place where there is no want of any thing that is in the earth.* When You go, You will come to a people unsuspecting, and the land is broad — for God has given it into Your hands, a place where there is no lack of anything that is on the earth."
- 11 *And there went from thence of the family of the Danites, out of Zorah and out of Eshtaol, six hundred men appointed with weapons of war.* So six hundred men of the family of the Danites, from Zorah and from Eshtaol, set out armed with weapons of war.
- 12 *And they went up, and pitched in Kirjathjearim, in Judah: wherefore they called that place Mahanehdan unto this day: behold, it is behind Kirjathjearim.* They went up and encamped at Kiriath-jearim in Judah. That is why that place is called Mahaneh-dan to this day; it lies behind Kiriath-jearim.

- 13 *And they passed thence unto mount Ephraim, and came unto the house of Micah.* From there they passed on to the hill country of Ephraim and came to the house of Micah.
- 14 *Then answered the five men that went to spy out the country of Laish, and said unto their brethren, Do ye know that there is in these houses an ephod, and teraphim, and a graven image, and a molten image? now therefore consider what ye have to do.* Then the five men who had gone to spy out the country of Laish said to their brothers, "Do You know that in these houses there are an ephod, household gods, a carved image, and a metal image? Now therefore consider what You will do."
- 15 *And they turned thitherward, and came to the house of the young man the Levite, even unto the house of Micah, and saluted him.* they turned aside there and came to the house of the young man the Levite, at the house of Micah, and greeted him.
- 16 *And the six hundred men appointed with their weapons of war, which were of the children of Dan, stood by the entering of the gate.* the six hundred men of the people of Dan, armed with their weapons of war, stood at the entrance of the gate.
- 17 *And the five men that went to spy out the land went up, and came in thither, and took the graven image, and the ephod, and the teraphim, and the molten image: and the priest stood in the entering of the gate with the six hundred men that were appointed with weapons of war.* the five men who had gone to spy out the land went up and entered and took the carved image, the ephod, the household gods, and the metal image. The priest stood at the entrance of the gate with the six hundred men armed with weapons of war.
- 18 *And these went into Micah's house, and fetched the carved image, the ephod, and the teraphim, and the molten image. Then said the priest unto them, What do ye?* When these men went into Micah's house and brought out the carved image, the ephod, the household gods, and the metal image, the priest said to them, "What are you doing?"

- 19 *And they said unto him, Hold thy peace, lay thine hand upon thy mouth, and go with us, and be to us a father and a priest: is it better for thee to be a priest unto the house of one man, or that thou be a priest unto a tribe and a family in Israel?* They said to him, "Keep silent. Put your hand on your mouth and come with us, and be to us a father and a priest. Is it better for you to be priest to the house of one man, or to be priest to a tribe and a family in Israel?"
- 20 *And the priest's heart was glad, and he took the ephod, and the teraphim, and the graven image, and went in the midst of the people.* the priest's heart was glad. He took the ephod, the household gods, and the carved image, and went along with the people.
- 21 *So they turned and departed, and put the little ones and the cattle and the carriage before them.* So they turned and departed, putting the little ones and the livestock and the goods in front of them.
- 22 *And when they were a good way from the house of Micah, the men that were in the houses near to Micah's house were gathered together, and overtook the children of Dan.* When they were a good distance from the house of Micah, the men who were in the houses near Micah's house were called out, and they overtook the people of Dan.
- 23 *And they cried unto the children of Dan. And they turned their faces, and said unto Micah, What aileth thee, that thou comest with such a company?* they called out to the people of Dan, who turned around and said to Micah, "What is the matter with you, that you come with such a company?"
- 24 *And he said, Ye have taken away my gods which I made, and the priest, and ye are gone away: and what have I more? and what is this that ye say unto me, What aileth thee?* He said, "You have taken away my gods that I made, and the priest, and gone away. What have I left? How then do you ask me, 'What is the matter with you?' "
- 25 *And the children of Dan said unto him, Let not thy voice be heard among us, lest angry fellows run upon thee, and thou lose thy life, with the lives of thy household.* the people of Dan said to him, "Do not let your voice be heard among us, lest angry fellows fall upon you, and you lose your life with the lives of your household."

- 26 *And the children of Dan went their way: and when Micah saw that they were too strong for him, he turned and went back unto his house.* Then the people of Dan went their way. When Micah saw that they were too strong for him, he turned and went back to his house.
- 27 *And they took the things which Micah had made, and the priest which he had, and came unto Laish, unto a people that were at quiet and secure: and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and burnt the city with fire.* But the people of Dan took what Micah had made, and the priest who belonged to him. They came to Laish, to a people quiet and unsuspecting, and struck them with the edge of the sword and burned the city with fire.
- 28 *And there was no deliverer, because it was far from Zidon, and they had no business with any man; and it was in the valley that lieth by Bethrehab. And they built a city, and dwelt therein.* there was no deliverer because it was far from Sidon. They had no dealings with anyone. It was in the valley that belongs to Bethrehab. Then they rebuilt the city and lived in it.
- 29 *And they called the name of the city Dan, after the name of Dan their father, who was born unto Israel: howbeit the name of the city was Laish at the first.* they called the name of the city Dan, after the name of Dan their ancestor, who was born to Israel; but the name of the city was Laish at the first.
- 30 *And the children of Dan set up the graven image: and Jonathan, the son of Gershom, the son of Manasseh, he and his sons were priests to the tribe of Dan until the day of the captivity of the land.* the people of Dan set up the carved image for themselves, and Jonathan the son of Gershom, son of Manasseh, and his sons were priests to the tribe of Danites until the day of the captivity of the land.
- 31 *And they set them up Micah's graven image, which he made, all the time that the house of God was in Shiloh.* So they set up Micah's carved image that he made, as long as the house of God was at Shiloh.

Words in this chapter:

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 17:6; Judg 1:34; Judg 19:1; Josh 19:40-48; Judg 21:25
v2 — Judg 13:25
v7 — Josh 19:47
v12 — Judg 13:25
v14 — Judg 17:5
v19 — Job 21:5; Judg 17:10; Job 29:9
v24 — Hab 2:18-19
v27 — Josh 19:47; Judg 18:7
v28 — 2 Sam 10:6
v29 — Josh 19:47
v31 — Josh 18:1

Chapter 19

A Levite traveling with his concubine lodged in Gibeah of Benjamin, where the men of the city demanded to assault him. His concubine was given to them and was abused until she died; the Levite cut her body into twelve pieces and sent them throughout Israel.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass in those days, when there was no king in Israel, that there was a certain Levite sojourning on the side of mount Ephraim, who took to him a concubine out of Bethlehemjudah.</i></p> | <p>In those days, when there was no king in Israel, a certain Levite was sojourning in the remote parts of the hill country of Ephraim, who took to himself a concubine from Bethlehemjudah.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And his concubine played the whore against him, and went away from him unto her father's house to Bethlehemjudah, and was there four whole months.</i></p> | <p>his concubine was unfaithful to him. She went away from him to her father's house at Bethlehemjudah, and was there some four months.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And her husband arose, and went after her, to speak friendly unto her, and to bring her again, having his servant with him, and a couple of asses: and she brought him into her father's house: and when the father of the damsel saw him, he rejoiced to meet him.</i></p> | <p>Then her husband arose and went after her, to speak kindly to her and bring her back. He had with him his servant and a couple of donkeys. And she brought him into her father's house. And when the girl's father saw him, he came with joy to meet him.</p> |

- 4 *And his father in law, the damsel's father, retained him; and he abode with him three days: so they did eat and drink, and lodged there.* his father-in-law, the girl's father, made him stay, and he remained with him three days. So they ate and drank and spent the night there.
- 5 *And it came to pass on the fourth day, when they arose early in the morning, that he rose up to depart: and the damsel's father said unto his son in law, Comfort thine heart with a morsel of bread, and afterward go your way.* On the fourth day they arose early in the morning, and he rose up to go, but the girl's father said to his son-in-law, "Strengthen your heart with a piece of bread, and afterward you may go."
- 6 *And they sat down, and did eat and drink both of them together: for the damsel's father had said unto the man, Be content, I pray thee, and tarry all night, and let thine heart be merry.* So they sat down and ate and drank, the two of them together. And the girl's father said to the man, "Be content to stay the night and let your heart be merry."
- 7 *And when the man rose up to depart, his father in law urged him: therefore he lodged there again.* When the man rose up to go, his father-in-law urged him, so he spent the night there again.
- 8 *And he arose early in the morning on the fifth day to depart: and the damsel's father said, Comfort thine heart, I pray thee. And they tarried until afternoon, and they did eat both of them.* On the fifth day he arose early in the morning to go, and the girl's father said, "Strengthen your heart and wait until the afternoon." So they ate, the two of them.
- 9 *And when the man rose up to depart, he, and his concubine, and his servant, his father in law, the damsel's father, said unto him, Behold, now the day draweth toward evening, I pray you tarry all night: behold, the day groweth to an end, lodge here, that thine heart may be merry; and to morrow get you early on your way, that thou mayest go home.* When the man rose up to go, he and his concubine and his servant, his father-in-law, the girl's father, said to him, "Now the day is drawing toward evening — please spend the night. The day is coming to an end. Lodge here and let your heart be merry. Tomorrow you will get up early for your journey and go home."

- 10 *But the man would not tarry that night, but he rose up and departed, and came over against Jebus, which is Jerusalem; and there were with him two asses saddled, his concubine also was with him.* But the man would not spend the night. He rose up and departed and arrived opposite Jebus (that is, Jerusalem). He had with him two saddled donkeys, and his concubine was with him.
- 11 *And when they were by Jebus, the day was far spent; and the servant said unto his master, Come, I pray thee, and let us turn in into this city of the Jebusites, and lodge in it.* When they were near Jebus, the day was far spent, and the servant said to his master, "Come, let us turn aside to this city of the Jebusites and spend the night in it."
- 12 *And his master said unto him, We will not turn aside hither into the city of a stranger, that is not of the children of Israel; we will pass over to Gibeah.* His master said to him, "We will not turn aside into the city of foreigners, who do not belong to the people of Israel, but we will pass on to Gibeah."
- 13 *And he said unto his servant, Come, and let us draw near to one of these places to lodge all night, in Gibeah, or in Ramah.* He said to his servant, "Come, let us draw near to one of these places and spend the night at Gibeah or at Ramah."
- 14 *And they passed on and went their way; and the sun went down upon them when they were by Gibeah, which belongeth to Benjamin.* So they passed on and went their way. And the sun went down on them near Gibeah, which belongs to Benjamin.
- 15 *And they turned aside thither, to go in and to lodge in Gibeah: and when he went in, he sat him down in a street of the city: for there was no man that took them into his house to lodging.* they turned aside there, to go in and spend the night at Gibeah. And he went in and sat down in the open square of the city, for no one took them into his house to spend the night.
- 16 *And, behold, there came an old man from his work out of the field at even, which was also of mount Ephraim; and he sojourned in Gibeah: but the men of the place were Benjamites.* an old man was coming from his work in the field at evening. The man was from the hill country of Ephraim. He was sojourning in Gibeah. The men of the place were Benjaminites.

- 17 *And when he had lifted up his eyes, he saw a wayfaring man in the street of the city: and the old man said, Whither goest thou? and whence comest thou?* he lifted up his eyes and saw the traveler in the open square of the city. And the old man said, "Where are you going? And where do you come from?"
- 18 *And he said unto him, We are passing from Bethlehemjudah toward the side of mount Ephraim; from thence am I: and I went to Bethlehemjudah, but I am now going to the house of the LORD; and there is no man that receiveth me to house.* he said to Him, "We are passing from Bethlehemjudah to the remote parts of the hill country of Ephraim, from which I come. I went to Bethlehemjudah. I am going to the house of the LORD, but no one has taken me into his house.
- 19 *Yet there is both straw and provender for our asses; and there is bread and wine also for me, and for thy handmaid, and for the young man which is with thy servants: there is no want of any thing.* We have straw and feed for our donkeys, with bread and wine for me and Your female servant and the young man with Your servants. There is no lack of anything."
- 20 *And the old man said, Peace be with thee; howsoever let all thy wants lie upon me; only lodge not in the street.* the old man said, "Peace be to You; I will care for all Your wants. Only, do not spend the night in the square."
- 21 *So he brought him into his house, and gave provender unto the asses: and they washed their feet, and did eat and drink.* So He brought Him into His house and gave the donkeys feed. And they washed their feet, and ate and drank.
- 22 *Now as they were making their hearts merry, behold, the men of the city, certain sons of Belial, beset the house round about, and beat at the door, and spake to the master of the house, the old man, saying, Bring forth the man that came into thine house, that we may know him.* As they were making their hearts merry, the men of the city, worthless fellows, surrounded the house, beating on the door. And they said to the old man, the master of the house, "Bring out the man who came into your house, that we may know him."

- 23 *And the man, the master of the house, went out unto them, and said unto them, Nay, my brethren, nay, I pray you, do not so wickedly; seeing that this man is come into mine house, do not this folly.* the man, the master of the house, went out to them and said to them, "No, my brothers, do not act so wickedly; since this man has come into my house, do not do this vile thing.
- 24 *Behold, here is my daughter a maiden, and his concubine; them I will bring out now, and humble ye them, and do with them what seemeth good unto you: but unto this man do not so vile a thing.* Here is my virgin daughter, and his concubine. I will bring them out now. Humble them and do with them what seems good to you, but to this man do not do this vile thing."
- 25 *But the men would not hearken to him: so the man took his concubine, and brought her forth unto them; and they knew her, and abused her all the night until the morning: and when the day began to spring, they let her go.* But the men would not listen to him. So the man seized his concubine and made her go out to them. And they knew her and abused her all night until the morning. And as the dawn began to break, they let her go.
- 26 *Then came the woman in the dawning of the day, and fell down at the door of the man's house where her lord was, till it was light.* as morning appeared, the woman came and fell down at the door of the man's house where her master was, until it was light.
- 27 *And her lord rose up in the morning, and opened the doors of the house, and went out to go his way: and, behold, the woman his concubine was fallen down at the door of the house, and her hands were upon the threshold.* her master rose up in the morning, and when he opened the doors of the house and went out to go on his way, there was his concubine lying at the door of the house, with her hands on the threshold.
- 28 *And he said unto her, Up, and let us be going. But none answered. Then the man took her up upon an ass, and the man rose up, and gat him unto his place.* He said to her, "Get up, let us be going." But there was no answer. Then he put her on the donkey, and the man rose up and went away to his home.

- 29 *And when he was come into his house, he took a knife, and laid hold on his concubine, and divided her, together with her bones, into twelve pieces, and sent her into all the coasts of Israel.* when he entered his house, he took a knife, and taking hold of his concubine he divided her, limb by limb, into twelve pieces, and sent her throughout all the territory of Israel.
- 30 *And it was so, that all that saw it said, There was no such deed done nor seen from the day that the children of Israel came up out of the land of Egypt unto this day: consider of it, take advice, and speak your minds.* all who saw it said, "Such a thing has never happened or been seen from the day that the people of Israel came up out of the land of Egypt until this day; consider it, take counsel, and speak."

Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 18:1
 v5 — Gen 18:5; Judg 19:8
 v6 — Judg 19:9; Judg 16:25; Ruth 3:7
 v22 — Gen 19:4-5; 1 Cor 6:9; Judg 20:5
 v23 — Gen 34:7; 2 Sam 13:12; Judg 20:6
 v24 — Gen 19:8
 v29 — 1 Sam 11:7; Judg 20:6-7
 v30 — Judg 20:7

Chapter 20

All Israel assembled against Gibeah to punish the crime, but Benjamin refused to surrender the guilty men. Israel was twice defeated before the LORD gave them victory on the third day at the battle of Gibeah; nearly the entire tribe of Benjamin was destroyed, with only 600 men surviving.

- 1 *Then all the children of Israel went out, and the congregation was gathered together as one man, from Dan even to Beersheba, with the land of Gilead, unto the LORD in Mizpeh.* Then all the people of Israel came out, from Dan to Beersheba, including the land of Gilead, and the congregation assembled as one man to the LORD at Mizpah.

- 2 *And the chief of all the people, even of all the tribes of Israel, presented themselves in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen that drew sword.* the chiefs of all the people, of all the tribes of Israel, presented themselves in the assembly of the people of God, 400,000 men on foot who drew the sword.
- 3 *(Now the children of Benjamin heard that the children of Israel were gone up to Mizpeh.) Then said the children of Israel, Tell us, how was this wickedness?* (Now the people of Benjamin heard that the people of Israel had gone up to Mizpah.) And the people of Israel said, "Tell us, how did this evil happen?"
- 4 *And the Levite, the husband of the woman that was slain, answered and said, I came into Gibeah that belongeth to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to lodge.* the Levite, the husband of the woman who was murdered, answered and said, "I came to Gibeah that belongs to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to spend the night.
- 5 *And the men of Gibeah rose against me, and beset the house round about upon me by night, and thought to have slain me: and my concubine have they forced, that she is dead.* the leaders of Gibeah rose against me and surrounded the house against me by night. They meant to kill me. They violated my concubine. She is dead.
- 6 *And I took my concubine, and cut her in pieces, and sent her throughout all the country of the inheritance of Israel: for they have committed lewdness and folly in Israel.* I took my concubine and cut her in pieces and sent her throughout all the country of the inheritance of Israel, for they have committed abomination and outrage in Israel.
- 7 *Behold, ye are all children of Israel; give here your advice and counsel.* you people of Israel, all of you, give your advice and counsel here."
- 8 *And all the people arose as one man, saying, We will not any of us go to his tent, neither will we any of us turn into his house.* all the people arose as one man, saying, "None of us will go to his tent, and none of us will return to his house.
- 9 *But now this shall be the thing which we will do to Gibeah; we will go up by lot against it;* But now this is what we will do to Gibeah: we will go up against it by lot.

- 10 *And we will take ten men of an hundred throughout all the tribes of Israel, and an hundred of a thousand, and a thousand out of ten thousand, to fetch victual for the people, that they may do, when they come to Gibeah of Benjamin, according to all the folly that they have wrought in Israel.* We will take ten men of every hundred throughout all the tribes of Israel, and a hundred of every thousand, and a thousand of every ten thousand, to bring provisions for the people, so that when they come to Gibeah of Benjamin they may deal with all the outrage they have committed in Israel."
- 11 *So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, knit together as one man.* So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, united as one man.
- 12 *And the tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, What wickedness is this that is done among you?* the tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, "What evil is this that has been done among you?"
- 13 *Now therefore deliver us the men, the children of Belial, which are in Gibeah, that we may put them to death, and put away evil from Israel. But the children of Benjamin would not hearken to the voice of their brethren the children of Israel:* Now therefore give up the men, the worthless fellows in Gibeah, that we may put them to death and put away evil from Israel." But the people of Benjamin would not listen to the voice of their brothers, the people of Israel.
- 14 *But the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together out of the cities unto Gibeah, to go out to battle against the children of Israel.* the people of Benjamin gathered themselves together out of the cities to Gibeah, to go out to battle against the people of Israel.
- 15 *And the children of Benjamin were numbered at that time out of the cities twenty and six thousand men that drew sword, beside the inhabitants of Gibeah, which were numbered seven hundred chosen men.* the people of Benjamin numbered on that day from the cities 26,000 men who drew the sword, besides the inhabitants of Gibeah, who numbered 700 chosen men.

- 16 *Among all this people there were seven hundred chosen men lefthanded; every one could sling stones at an hair breadth, and not miss.* Among all these soldiers were 700 chosen men who were left-handed; every one of them could sling a stone at a hair and not miss.
- 17 *And the men of Israel, beside Benjamin, were numbered four hundred thousand men that drew sword: all these were men of war.* the men of Israel, apart from Benjamin, numbered 400,000 men who drew the sword; all these were men of war.
- 18 *And the children of Israel arose, and went up to the house of God, and asked counsel of God, and said, Which of us shall go up first to the battle against the children of Benjamin? And the LORD said, Judah shall go up first.* The people of Israel arose and went up to the house of God and inquired of God, "Which of us shall go up first to fight against the people of Benjamin?" And the LORD said, "Judah shall go up first."
- 19 *And the children of Israel rose up in the morning, and encamped against Gibeah.* the people of Israel rose in the morning and encamped against Gibeah.
- 20 *And the men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin; and the men of Israel put themselves in array to fight against them at Gibeah.* the men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin, and the men of Israel drew up the battle line against them at Gibeah.
- 21 *And the children of Benjamin came forth out of Gibeah, and destroyed down to the ground of the Israelites that day twenty and two thousand men.* the people of Benjamin came out of Gibeah and destroyed on that day 22,000 men of the Israelites.
- 22 *And the people the men of Israel encouraged themselves, and set their battle again in array in the place where they put themselves in array the first day.* But the people, the men of Israel, took courage and again formed the battle line in the same place where they had drawn up on the first day.

- 23 *(And the children of Israel went up and wept before the LORD until even, and asked counsel of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up again to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother? And the LORD said, Go up against him.)* (The people of Israel went up and wept before the LORD until evening, and they inquired of the LORD, "Shall we again draw near to battle against our brothers, the people of Benjamin?" And the LORD said, "Go up against them.")
- 24 *And the children of Israel came near against the children of Benjamin the second day.* so the people of Israel came near against the people of Benjamin the second day.
- 25 *And Benjamin went forth against them out of Gibeah the second day, and destroyed down to the ground of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men; all these drew the sword.* Benjamin went out against them from Gibeah the second day and destroyed 18,000 more men of the people of Israel. All these were men who drew the sword.
- 26 *Then all the children of Israel, and all the people, went up, and came unto the house of God, and wept, and sat there before the LORD, and fasted that day until even, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.* Then all the people of Israel, the whole army, went up and came to the house of God. They wept and sat there before the LORD and fasted that day until evening. They offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.
- 27 *And the children of Israel enquired of the LORD, (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days,* the people of Israel inquired of the LORD (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days,
- 28 *And Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days,) saying, Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And the LORD said, Go up; for to morrow I will deliver them into thine hand.* and Phinehas the son of Eleazar, son of Aaron, ministered before it in those days), saying, "Shall we go out yet again to battle against our brothers, the people of Benjamin, or shall we cease?" The LORD said, "Go up, for tomorrow I will give them into Your hand."

- 29 *And Israel set liers in wait round about Gibeah.* So Israel set men in ambush around Gibeah.
- 30 *And the children of Israel went up against the children of Benjamin on the third day, and put themselves in array against Gibeah, as at other times.* the people of Israel went up against the people of Benjamin on the third day and set themselves in battle order against Gibeah, as at other times.
- 31 *And the children of Benjamin went out against the people, and were drawn away from the city; and they began to smite of the people, and kill, as at other times, in the highways, of which one goeth up to the house of God, and the other to Gibeah in the field, about thirty men of Israel.* the people of Benjamin went out against the people and were drawn away from the city. They began to strike and kill some of the people, as at other times, on the highways, one of which goes up to Bethel and the other to Gibeah, in the open field, killing about thirty men of Israel.
- 32 *And the children of Benjamin said, They are smitten down before us, as at the first. But the children of Israel said, Let us flee, and draw them from the city unto the highways.* the people of Benjamin said, "They are being defeated before us, as at the first." But the people of Israel said, "Let us flee and draw them away from the city to the highways."
- 33 *And all the men of Israel rose up out of their place, and put themselves in array at Baaltamar: and the liers in wait of Israel came forth out of their places, even out of the meadows of Gibeah.* all the men of Israel rose up out of their place and set themselves in battle order at Baal-tamar, and the men of Israel in ambush rushed out of their places, out of the open ground west of Gibeah.
- 34 *And there came against Gibeah ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and the battle was sore: but they knew not that evil was near them.* Ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel came against Gibeah, and the battle was fierce. But the Benjaminites did not know that disaster was close upon them.

- 35 *And the LORD smote Benjamin before Israel: and the children of Israel destroyed of the Benjamites that day twenty and five thousand and an hundred men: all these drew the sword.* the LORD defeated Benjamin before Israel, and the people of Israel destroyed 25,100 men of Benjamin that day. All these were men who drew the sword.
- 36 *So the children of Benjamin saw that they were smitten: for the men of Israel gave place to the Benjamites, because they trusted unto the liers in wait which they had set beside Gibeah.* So the people of Benjamin saw that they were defeated. The men of Israel gave ground to Benjamin because they trusted in the men in ambush whom they had set against Gibeah.
- 37 *And the liers in wait hasted, and rushed upon Gibeah; and the liers in wait drew themselves along, and smote all the city with the edge of the sword.* Then the men in ambush hurried and rushed against Gibeah; the men in ambush moved out and struck all the city with the edge of the sword.
- 38 *Now there was an appointed sign between the men of Israel and the liers in wait, that they should make a great flame with smoke rise up out of the city.* Now the appointed signal between the men of Israel and the men in ambush was that they should make a great cloud of smoke rise up out of the city.
- 39 *And when the men of Israel retired in the battle, Benjamin began to smite and kill of the men of Israel about thirty persons: for they said, Surely they are smitten down before us, as in the first battle.* So when the men of Israel turned in the battle, Benjamin began to strike and kill about thirty men of Israel. They said, "Surely they are defeated before us, as in the first battle."
- 40 *But when the flame began to arise up out of the city with a pillar of smoke, the Benjamites looked behind them, and, behold, the flame of the city ascended up to heaven.* But when the cloud began to rise out of the city in a column of smoke, the Benjaminites looked behind them, and the whole city was going up in smoke to the heavens.

- 41 *And when the men of Israel turned again, the men of Benjamin were amazed: for they saw that evil was come upon them.* Then the men of Israel turned, and the men of Benjamin were terrified, for they saw that disaster had come upon them.
- 42 *Therefore they turned their backs before the men of Israel unto the way of the wilderness; but the battle overtook them; and them which came out of the cities they destroyed in the midst of them.* They turned their backs before the men of Israel toward the way of the wilderness, but the battle overtook them, and those who came out of the cities destroyed them in the midst of them.
- 43 *Thus they inclosed the Benjamites round about, and chased them, and trode them down with ease over against Gibeah toward the sunrising.* They surrounded the Benjaminites, chased them, and trod them down at their resting place, as far as opposite Gibeah toward the sunrising.
- 44 *And there fell of Benjamin eighteen thousand men; all these were men of valour.* Eighteen thousand men of Benjamin fell, all of them men of valor.
- 45 *And they turned and fled toward the wilderness unto the rock of Rimmon: and they gleaned of them in the highways five thousand men; and pursued hard after them unto Gidom, and slew two thousand men of them.* They turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon. Five thousand men of them were cut down on the highways, and they pursued them hard to Gidom and killed two thousand more men of them.
- 46 *So that all which fell that day of Benjamin were twenty and five thousand men that drew the sword; all these were men of valour.* So all who fell that day of Benjamin were 25,000 men who drew the sword, all of them men of valor.
- 47 *But six hundred men turned and fled to the wilderness unto the rock Rimmon, and abode in the rock Rimmon four months.* But 600 men turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon and remained at the rock of Rimmon four months.

- 48 *And the men of Israel turned again upon the children of Benjamin, and smote them with the edge of the sword, as well the men of every city, as the beast, and all that came to hand: also they set on fire all the cities that they came to.* the men of Israel turned back against the people of Benjamin and struck them with the edge of the sword, the city, men and beasts and all that they found. And all the towns that they found they set on fire.
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Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 11:11
- v2 — Judg 8:10
- v5 — Judg 19:22
- v6 — Judg 19:29
- v7 — Judg 19:30
- v8 — Eccl 9:10
- v13 — Deut 17:12
- v16 — Judg 3:15; 1 Chr 12:2
- v18 — Num 27:21; Judg 20:26-27; Judg 20:23
- v26 — Judg 20:23
- v28 — Judg 7:9
- v29 — Josh 8:4

Chapter 21

Israel grieved that Benjamin was nearly wiped out and devised two plans to provide wives for the 600 survivors—taking women from Jabesh-gilead and allowing the men to seize dancers at Shiloh. The book closes with the refrain that there was no king in Israel, and every man did what was right in his own eyes.

- 1 *Now the men of Israel had sworn in Mizpeh, saying, There shall not any of us give his daughter unto Benjamin to wife.* Now the men of Israel had sworn at Mizpah, "No one of us shall give his daughter in marriage to Benjamin."

- 2 *And the people came to the house of God, and abode there till even before God, and lifted up their voices, and wept sore;* the people came to the house of God and sat there till evening before God. They lifted up their voices and wept bitterly.
- 3 *And said, O LORD God of Israel, why is this come to pass in Israel, that there should be to day one tribe lacking in Israel?* They said, "O LORD, the God of Israel, why has this happened in Israel, that today there should be one tribe lacking in Israel?"
- 4 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that the people rose early, and built there an altar, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings.* the next day the people rose early and built there an altar and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings.
- 5 *And the children of Israel said, Who is there among all the tribes of Israel that came not up with the congregation unto the LORD? For they had made a great oath concerning him that came not up to the LORD to Mizpah, saying, He shall surely be put to death.* the people of Israel said, "Which of all the tribes of Israel did not come up in the assembly to the LORD?" For they had taken a great oath concerning Him who did not come up to the LORD to Mizpah, saying, "He shall surely be put to death."
- 6 *And the children of Israel repented them for Benjamin their brother, and said, There is one tribe cut off from Israel this day.* the people of Israel had compassion for Benjamin their brother and said, "One tribe is cut off from Israel this day.
- 7 *How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing we have sworn by the LORD that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?* What shall we do for wives for those who are left, since we have sworn by the LORD not to give them any of our daughters as wives?"
- 8 *And they said, What one is there of the tribes of Israel that came not up to Mizpah to the LORD? And, behold, there came none to the camp from Jabeshgilead to the assembly.* They said, "Which of the tribes of Israel did not come up to the LORD at Mizpah?" And no one had come to the camp from Jabesh-gilead to the assembly.

- 9 *For the people were numbered, and, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead there.* For when the people were mustered, none of the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead were there.
- 10 *And the congregation sent thither twelve thousand men of the valiantest, and commanded them, saying, Go and smite the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the children.* So the congregation sent there 12,000 of their bravest men and commanded them, "Go and strike the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the little ones.
- 11 *And this is the thing that ye shall do, Ye shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman that hath lain by man.* This is what You shall do: every male and every woman who has lain with a man you shall devote to destruction."
- 12 *And they found among the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead four hundred young virgins, that had known no man by lying with any male: and they brought them unto the camp to Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan.* Among the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead they found 400 young virgins who had not known a man by lying with him, and they brought them to the camp at Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan.
- 13 *And the whole congregation sent some to speak to the children of Benjamin that were in the rock Rimmon, and to call peaceably unto them.* the whole congregation sent word to the people of Benjamin who were at the rock of Rimmon and proclaimed peace to them.
- 14 *And Benjamin came again at that time; and they gave them wives which they had saved alive of the women of Jabeshgilead: and yet so they sufficed them not.* Benjamin returned at that time, and they gave them the women whom they had saved alive of the women of Jabesh-gilead. But they were not enough for them.
- 15 *And the people repented them for Benjamin, because that the LORD had made a breach in the tribes of Israel.* the people had compassion for Benjamin, because the LORD had made a breach in the tribes of Israel.

- 16 *Then the elders of the congregation said, How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing the women are destroyed out of Benjamin?* Then the elders of the congregation said, "What shall we do for wives for those who are left, since the women of Benjamin have been destroyed?"
- 17 *And they said, There must be an inheritance for them that be escaped of Benjamin, that a tribe be not destroyed out of Israel.* They said, "There must be an inheritance for the survivors of Benjamin, so that a tribe may not be blotted out of Israel.
- 18 *Howbeit we may not give them wives of our daughters: for the children of Israel have sworn, saying, Cursed be he that giveth a wife to Benjamin.* Yet we cannot give them wives from our daughters, for the people of Israel have sworn, 'Cursed is he who gives a wife to Benjamin.'"
- 19 *Then they said, Behold, there is a feast of the LORD in Shiloh yearly in a place which is on the north side of Bethel, on the east side of the highway that goeth up from Bethel to Shechem, and on the south of Lebonah.* So they said, "There is a yearly feast of the LORD at Shiloh, which is north of Bethel, on the east of the highway that goes up from Bethel to Shechem, and south of Lebonah."
- 20 *Therefore they commanded the children of Benjamin, saying, Go and lie in wait in the vineyards;* They commanded the people of Benjamin, saying, "Go and lie in wait in the vineyards,
- 21 *And see, and, behold, if the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance in dances, then come ye out of the vineyards, and catch you every man his wife of the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin.* and watch. When the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance in the dances, then come out from the vineyards and snatch each man his wife from the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin.
- 22 *And it shall be, when their fathers or their brethren come unto us to complain, that we will say unto them, Be favourable unto them for our sakes: because we reserved not to each man his wife in the war: for ye did not give unto them at this time, that ye should be guilty.* And when their fathers or their brothers come to complain to us, we will say to them, 'Be generous to them for our sake; because we did not take for each man of them his wife in battle, and you did not give them to them, else You would now be guilty.'"

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| 23 | <i>And the children of Benjamin did so, and took them wives, according to their number, of them that danced, whom they caught: and they went and returned unto their inheritance, and repaired the cities, and dwelt in them.</i> | the people of Benjamin did so and took their wives, according to their number, from the dancers whom they carried off. Then they went and returned to their inheritance, rebuilt the towns, and lived in them. |
| 24 | <i>And the children of Israel departed thence at that time, every man to his tribe and to his family, and they went out from thence every man to his inheritance.</i> | the people of Israel departed from there at that time, every man to his tribe and family, and they went out from there every man to his inheritance. |
| 25 | <i>In those days there was no king in Israel: every man did that which was right in his own eyes.</i> | In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did what was right in His own eyes. |
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Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Judg 20:1
- v4 — 2 Sam 24:25
- v5 — Judg 5:23
- v13 — Deut 20:10; Judg 20:47
- v18 — Judg 21:1
- v21 — Judg 11:34; Ex 15:20
- v23 — Judg 20:48
- v25 — Deut 12:8; Judg 17:6; Prov 3:5; Eccl 11:9; Prov 14:12

Ruth

Author: Unknown — Jewish tradition names Samuel, though this is uncertain.

Date written: The events occur during the period of the judges (c. 1150–1100 BC); the book was likely written in the early monarchy, possibly c. 1000 BC.

Written to: The people of Israel, to demonstrate God's providence and the inclusion of the nations in His redemptive plan.

Setting: "In the days when the judges ruled" — a dark, lawless era in Israel. A family from Bethlehem emigrates to Moab to escape famine. The husband and both sons die. The widow Naomi returns to Israel with her Moabite daughter-in-law Ruth, and God's providence unfolds through an unlikely kinsman-redeemer named Boaz.

Where this sits historically: c. 1100 BC during the latter judges era, in a famine that drove Naomi's family from Bethlehem to Moab; the Philistines dominate the coastal plain.

Contemporaries: The judges of Israel — possibly Jephthah, Ibzan, or Samson; Egypt's 20th dynasty in decline. Ruth's great-grandson David will be born about a century later.

Big themes:

- Providence — God is never mentioned performing miracles, but His hand guides every coincidence and kindness in the story
- The kinsman-redeemer — Boaz's role as goel (redeemer) who buys back Naomi's land and takes Ruth as his wife is one of the OT's clearest pictures of what Christ does for the church
- Loyalty — Ruth's declaration to Naomi ("whither thou goest, I will go") is one of Scripture's greatest statements of covenantal faithfulness
- The Gentile in the covenant — Ruth is a Moabite, yet she is grafted into Israel and into the line of David
- Reversal — Naomi goes out full and returns empty; she returns empty and is filled again; God restores what was lost

Key passages: Ruth 1:16–17; 2:12; 3:9; 4:14–15; 4:17

How it fits: Ruth is placed between Judges and 1 Samuel as a breath of grace in the darkest period of Israel's history. Its climax — the birth of Obed, father of Jesse, father of David — anchors Ruth directly in the Davidic and ultimately messianic lineage. Matthew 1:5 names Ruth in the genealogy of Christ.

Chapter 1

Naomi loses her husband and both sons in Moab and sets out to return to Bethlehem. She urges her daughters-in-law to stay behind; Orpah turns back, but Ruth refuses to leave and pledges her loyalty. They arrive in Bethlehem at the beginning of barley harvest.

- 1

Now it came to pass in the days when the judges ruled, that there was a famine in the land. And a certain man of Bethlehemjudah went to sojourn in the country of Moab, he, and his wife, and his two sons.

In the days when the judges ruled there was a famine in the land, and a man of Bethlehemjudah went to stay in the country of Moab, he and his wife and his two sons.
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And the name of the man was Elimelech, and the name of his wife Naomi, and the name of his two sons Mahlon and Chilion, Ephrathites of Bethlehemjudah. And they came into the country of Moab, and continued there.

The name of the man was Elimelech and the name of his wife Naomi, and the names of his two sons were Mahlon and Chilion. They were Ephrathites from Bethlehemjudah. They went into the country of Moab and remained there.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elimelech** (eh-LIM-eh-lek) — "my God is king" — A man of Bethlehem who took his family to Moab during a famine. His death there, along with his two sons, set the stage for the story of redemption through Ruth and Boaz.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Naomi** (nay-OH-mee) — "pleasant" — Wife of Elimelech, mother-in-law to Ruth and Orpah. After losing her husband and both sons in Moab, she renamed herself Mara ("bitter") but lived to see God's providence restore her through Ruth's marriage to Boaz.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mahlon** (MAH-lon) — "sickly" — One of Naomi's two sons who married a Moabite woman (Ruth) and died in Moab without children.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Chilion** (KIL-ee-on) — "wasting" — Naomi's other son who married Orpah and died in Moab without children.

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And Elimelech Naomi's husband died; and she was left, and her two sons.

But Elimelech, the husband of Naomi, died. She was left with her two sons.
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And they took them wives of the women of Moab; the name of the one was Orpah, and the name of the other Ruth: and they dwelt there about ten years.

These took Moabite wives; the name of the one was Orpah and the name of the other Ruth. They lived there about ten years,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Orpah** (OR-pah) — "back of the neck" — Naomi's Moabite daughter-in-law who, at Naomi's urging, turned back to Moab and her gods. Her departure contrasts with Ruth's famous declaration of loyalty.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ruth** (ROOTH) — "friend, companion" — A Moabite widow who refused to leave her mother-in-law Naomi, declaring "your people shall be my people, and your God my God." She became the wife of Boaz and the great-grandmother of King David, entering the lineage of Christ (Matthew 1:5).

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| <p>5 <i>And Mahlon and Chilion died also both of them; and the woman was left of her two sons and her husband.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Then she arose with her daughters in law, that she might return from the country of Moab: for she had heard in the country of Moab how that the LORD had visited his people in giving them bread.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Wherefore she went forth out of the place where she was, and her two daughters in law with her; and they went on the way to return unto the land of Judah.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Naomi said unto her two daughters in law, Go, return each to her mother's house: the LORD deal kindly with you, as ye have dealt with the dead, and with me.</i></p> <p>9 <i>The LORD grant you that ye may find rest, each of you in the house of her husband. Then she kissed them; and they lifted up their voice, and wept.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And they said unto her, Surely we will return with thee unto thy people.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Naomi said, Turn again, my daughters: why will ye go with me? are there yet any more sons in my womb, that they may be your husbands?</i></p> | <p>both Mahlon and Chilion died, so that the woman was left without her two sons and her husband.</p> <p>Then she arose with her daughters-in-law to return from the country of Moab, for she had heard in the fields of Moab that the LORD had visited His people and given them food.</p> <p>So she set out from the place where she was with her two daughters-in-law. They went on the way to return to the land of Judah.</p> <p>But Naomi said to her two daughters-in-law, "Go, return each of You to her mother's house. May the LORD deal kindly with You, as You have dealt with the dead and with me.</p> <p>The LORD grant that You may find rest, each of You in the house of her husband!" Then she kissed them. They lifted up their voices and wept.</p> <p>they said to her, "Surely we will return with You to Your people."</p> <p>But Naomi said, "Turn back, my daughters; why will you go with me? Have I yet sons in my womb that they may become your husbands?</p> |
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- 12 *Turn again, my daughters, go your way; for I am too old to have an husband. If I should say, I have hope, if I should have an husband also to night, and should also bear sons;* Turn back, my daughters; go your way, for I am too old to have a husband. If I should say I have hope, even if I should have a husband this night and should bear sons,
- 13 *Would ye tarry for them till they were grown? would ye stay for them from having husbands? nay, my daughters; for it grieveth me much for your sakes that the hand of the LORD is gone out against me.* would You therefore wait till they were grown? Would You therefore refrain from marrying? No, my daughters, for it is greatly bitter to me for Your sake that the hand of the LORD has gone out against me."
- 14 *And they lifted up their voice, and wept again: and Orpah kissed her mother in law; but Ruth clave unto her.* Then they lifted up their voices and wept again. And Orpah kissed her mother-in-law, but Ruth clung to her.
- 15 *And she said, Behold, thy sister in law is gone back unto her people, and unto her gods: return thou after thy sister in law.* she said, "See, your sister-in-law has gone back to her people and to her gods; return after your sister-in-law."
- 16 *And Ruth said, Intreat me not to leave thee, or to return from following after thee: for whither thou goest, I will go; and where thou lodgest, I will lodge: thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God:* But Ruth said, "Do not urge me to leave you or to return from following you. For where you go I will go, and where you lodge I will lodge. Your people shall be my people, and your God my God.
- 17 *Where thou diest, will I die, and there will I be buried: the LORD do so to me, and more also, if ought but death part thee and me.* Where You die I will die, and there will I be buried. May the LORD do so to me and more also if anything but death parts me from You."
- 18 *When she saw that she was stedfastly minded to go with her, then she left speaking unto her.* when Naomi saw that she was determined to go with her, she said no more.

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| <p>19 <i>So they two went until they came to Bethlehem. And it came to pass, when they were come to Bethlehem, that all the city was moved about them, and they said, Is this Naomi?</i></p> <p>20 <i>And she said unto them, Call me not Naomi, call me Mara: for the Almighty hath dealt very bitterly with me.</i></p> <p>21 <i>I went out full, and the LORD hath brought me home again empty: why then call ye me Naomi, seeing the LORD hath testified against me, and the Almighty hath afflicted me?</i></p> <p>22 <i>So Naomi returned, and Ruth the Moabitess, her daughter in law, with her, which returned out of the country of Moab: and they came to Bethlehem in the beginning of barley harvest.</i></p> | <p>So the two of them went on until they came to Bethlehem. And when they came to Bethlehem, the whole town was stirred because of them. And the women said, "Is this Naomi?"</p> <p>She said to them, "Do not call me Naomi; call me Mara, for the Almighty has dealt very bitterly with me.</p> <p>I went away full. The LORD has brought me back empty. Why call me Naomi, when the LORD has testified against me and the Almighty has brought calamity upon me?"</p> <p>So Naomi returned, and Ruth the Moabitess her daughter-in-law with her, who returned from the country of Moab. And they came to Bethlehem at the beginning of barley harvest.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Naomi (*nay-OH-mee*) — Ruth's mother-in-law who returned to Bethlehem after her husband and sons died in Moab — her name means 'pleasant'; she called herself Mara ('bitter') in her grief.

Ruth (*ROOTH*) — A Moabite woman who left her homeland to stay with her mother-in-law Naomi — her loyalty and faith led to marriage with Boaz and a place in the lineage of Christ.

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 12:10; Gen 26:1; Ezek 14:13

v6 — Ps 132:15; Ps 111:5; Ex 3:16; Ex 4:31; Ex 16:4-6

- v8** — Ruth 1:5; Ruth 2:20; Col 3:18; Col 3:24
v9 — Ruth 3:1; Acts 20:37; Gen 29:11; Gen 27:27; Gen 45:15
v11 — Deut 25:5
v13 — Job 19:21; Ps 32:4; Judg 2:15
v14 — Prov 18:24; Matt 16:24; Matt 10:37
v16 — 2 Sam 15:21; Ruth 2:11-12; 2 Kgs 2:2-6; Ps 45:10; Matt 8:19
v17 — 1 Sam 3:17; 2 Sam 19:13; 1 Kgs 2:23; 2 Kgs 6:31; 1 Sam 25:22
v19 — Matt 21:10
v20 — Job 6:4; Heb 12:11; Ps 88:15
v21 — 1 Sam 2:7-8; Job 1:21

Chapter 2

Ruth goes out to glean and happens upon the field of Boaz, a wealthy kinsman of Elimelech. Boaz shows her unusual kindness, commanding his workers to protect her and leave extra grain for her. When Ruth tells Naomi the man's name, Naomi recognizes God's providence — Boaz is one of their kinsman-redeemers.

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| <p>¹ <i>And Naomi had a kinsman of her husband's, a mighty man of wealth, of the family of Elimelech; and his name was Boaz.</i></p> | <p>Now Naomi had a relative of her husband's, a worthy man of the clan of Elimelech, whose name was Boaz.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Boaz** (BOH-az) — "strength" — A wealthy landowner of Bethlehem, kinsman to Elimelech, who becomes Ruth's kinsman-redeemer and husband. His role as goel (redeemer) is one of the OT's clearest pictures of Christ's redeeming work. He is the great-grandfather of King David.

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| <p>² <i>And Ruth the Moabitess said unto Naomi, Let me now go to the field, and glean ears of corn after him in whose sight I shall find grace. And she said unto her, Go, my daughter.</i></p> | <p>Ruth the Moabitess said to Naomi, "Let me go to the field and glean among the ears of grain after him in whose sight I shall find favor." And she said to her, "Go, my daughter."</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And she went, and came, and gleaned in the field after the reapers: and her hap was to light on a part of the field belonging unto Boaz, who was of the kindred of Elimelech.</i></p> | <p>So she set out and went and gleaned in the field after the reapers. She happened to come to the part of the field belonging to Boaz, who was of the clan of Elimelech.</p> |

- 4 *And, behold, Boaz came from Bethlehem, and said unto the reapers, The LORD be with you. And they answered him, The LORD bless thee.* Boaz came from Bethlehem. And he said to the reapers, "The LORD be with You!" And they answered, "The LORD bless You."
- 5 *Then said Boaz unto his servant that was set over the reapers, Whose damsel is this?* Then Boaz said to his young man who was in charge of the reapers, "Whose young woman is this?"
- 6 *And the servant that was set over the reapers answered and said, It is the Moabitish damsel that came back with Naomi out of the country of Moab:* the servant who was in charge of the reapers answered, "She is the young Moabitess, who came back with Naomi from the country of Moab.
- 7 *And she said, I pray you, let me glean and gather after the reapers among the sheaves: so she came, and hath continued even from the morning until now, that she tarried a little in the house.* She said, 'Please let me glean and gather among the sheaves after the reapers.' So she came. She has continued from early morning until now, except for a short rest."
- 8 *Then said Boaz unto Ruth, Hearkest thou not, my daughter? Go not to glean in another field, neither go from hence, but abide here fast by my maidens:* Then Boaz said to Ruth, "Now, listen, my daughter, do not go to glean in another field or leave this one, but keep close to my young women.
- 9 *Let thine eyes be on the field that they do reap, and go thou after them: have I not charged the young men that they shall not touch thee? and when thou art athirst, go unto the vessels, and drink of that which the young men have drawn.* Let your eyes be on the field that they are reaping, and go after them. Have I not charged the young men not to touch you? And when you are thirsty, go to the vessels and drink what the young men have drawn."
- 10 *Then she fell on her face, and bowed herself to the ground, and said unto him, Why have I found grace in thine eyes, that thou shouldest take knowledge of me, seeing I am a stranger?* Then she fell on her face, bowing to the ground, and said to him, "Why have I found favor in your eyes, that you should take notice of me, since I am a foreigner?"

- 11 *And Boaz answered and said unto her, It hath fully been shewed me, all that thou hast done unto thy mother in law since the death of thine husband: and how thou hast left thy father and thy mother, and the land of thy nativity, and art come unto a people which thou knewest not heretofore.* But Boaz answered her, "All that you have done for your mother-in-law since the death of your husband has been fully told to me, and how you left your father and mother and your native land and came to a people that you did not know before.
- 12 *The LORD recompense thy work, and a full reward be given thee of the LORD God of Israel, under whose wings thou art come to trust.* The LORD repay You for what You have done, and a full reward be given You by the LORD, the God of Israel, under whose wings You have come to trust!"
- 13 *Then she said, Let me find favour in thy sight, my lord; for that thou hast comforted me, and for that thou hast spoken friendly unto thine handmaid, though I be not like unto one of thine handmaidens.* Then she said, "I have found favor in Your eyes, my lord, for You have comforted me and spoken kindly to Your servant, though I am not one of Your servants."
- 14 *And Boaz said unto her, At mealtime come thou hither, and eat of the bread, and dip thy morsel in the vinegar. And she sat beside the reapers: and he reached her parched corn, and she did eat, and was sufficed, and left.* at mealtime Boaz said to her, "Come here and eat some bread and dip your morsel in the vinegar." So she sat beside the reapers. He passed to her roasted grain. And she ate until she was satisfied. She had some left over.
- 15 *And when she was risen up to glean, Boaz commanded his young men, saying, Let her glean even among the sheaves, and reproach her not:* When she rose to glean, Boaz instructed his young men, saying, "Let her glean even among the sheaves, and do not reproach her.
- 16 *And let fall also some of the handfuls of purpose for her, and leave them, that she may glean them, and rebuke her not.* also let fall some handfuls of purpose for her and leave it for her to glean, and do not rebuke her."

- 17 *So she gleaned in the field until even, and beat out that she had gleaned: and it was about an ephah of barley.* So she gleaned in the field until evening. Then she beat out what she had gleaned. It was about an ephah of barley.
- 18 *And she took it up, and went into the city: and her mother in law saw what she had gleaned: and she brought forth, and gave to her that she had reserved after she was sufficed.* she took it up and went into the city. Her mother-in-law saw what she had gleaned. She also brought out and gave her what food she had left over after being satisfied.
- 19 *And her mother in law said unto her, Where hast thou gleaned to day? and where wroughtest thou? blessed be he that did take knowledge of thee. And she shewed her mother in law with whom she had wrought, and said, The man's name with whom I wrought to day is Boaz.* her mother-in-law said to her, "Where did you glean today? And where have you worked? Blessed be the man who took notice of you." So she told her mother-in-law with whom she had worked and said, "The man's name with whom I worked today is Boaz."
- 20 *And Naomi said unto her daughter in law, Blessed be he of the LORD, who hath not left off his kindness to the living and to the dead. And Naomi said unto her, The man is near of kin unto us, one of our next kinsmen.* Naomi said to her daughter-in-law, "May he be blessed by the LORD, whose kindness has not forsaken the living or the dead!" Naomi also said to her, "The man is a close relative of ours, one of our redeemers."
- 21 *And Ruth the Moabitess said, He said unto me also, Thou shalt keep fast by my young men, until they have ended all my harvest.* Ruth the Moabitess said, "Besides, he said to me, 'You shall keep close by my young men until they have finished all my harvest.' "
- 22 *And Naomi said unto Ruth her daughter in law, It is good, my daughter, that thou go out with his maidens, that they meet thee not in any other field.* Naomi said to Ruth, her daughter-in-law, "It is good, my daughter, that you go out with his young women, that they meet you not in any other field."

- 23 *So she kept fast by the maidens of Boaz to glean unto the end of barley harvest and of wheat harvest; and dwelt with her mother in law.* So she kept close to the young women of Boaz, gleaning until the end of the barley and wheat harvests. And she lived with her mother-in-law.

Words in this chapter:

Boaz (*BO-az*) — A wealthy landowner in Bethlehem who married Ruth — he acted as her kinsman-redeemer; ancestor of King David; his name means 'in him is strength.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ruth 4:21
- v2 — Lev 23:22; Lev 19:9; Deut 24:19-21
- v4 — Ps 129:7-8; Judg 6:12; Luke 1:28; 2 Thess 3:16; 2 Tim 4:22
- v6 — Ruth 1:22
- v8 — 2 Kgs 5:13
- v9 — 1 John 5:18; Gen 20:6
- v10 — 1 Sam 25:23; Ruth 2:13; 2 Sam 19:28; Luke 1:43; Luke 1:48
- v11 — Luke 14:33; Luke 18:29-30
- v12 — Ps 36:7; Ps 91:4; Ps 63:7; Ps 61:4; Ps 17:8
- v13 — 1 Sam 1:18; Gen 34:3; Gen 33:8; Phil 2:3
- v14 — Ruth 2:18
- v20 — 2 Sam 2:5; Ruth 3:9-10; Deut 25:5-7; Lev 25:25

Chapter 3

Naomi instructs Ruth to go to the threshing floor at night and lie at Boaz's feet. Ruth asks Boaz to act as her redeemer; he agrees but reveals there is a nearer kinsman who has the first right. He sends her home with six measures of barley, promising to settle the matter that day.

- 1 *Then Naomi her mother in law said unto her, My daughter, shall I not seek rest for thee, that it may be well with thee?* Then Naomi her mother-in-law said to her, "My daughter, should I not seek rest for you, that it may be well with you?
- 2 *And now is not Boaz of our kindred, with whose maidens thou wast? Behold, he winnoweth barley to night in the threshingfloor.* Is not Boaz our relative, with whose young women you were? See, he is winnowing barley tonight at the threshing floor.

- 3 *Wash thyself therefore, and anoint thee, and put thy raiment upon thee, and get thee down to the floor: but make not thyself known unto the man, until he shall have done eating and drinking.* Wash therefore and anoint yourself, and put on your cloak and go down to the threshing floor, but do not make yourself known to the man until he has finished eating and drinking.
- 4 *And it shall be, when he lieth down, that thou shalt mark the place where he shall lie, and thou shalt go in, and uncover his feet, and lay thee down; and he will tell thee what thou shalt do.* But when he lies down, observe the place where he lies. Then go and uncover his feet and lie down. He will tell you what to do."
- 5 *And she said unto her, All that thou sayest unto me I will do.* she replied, "All that you say I will do."
- 6 *And she went down unto the floor, and did according to all that her mother in law bade her.* So she went down to the threshing floor and did just as her mother-in-law had commanded her.
- 7 *And when Boaz had eaten and drunk, and his heart was merry, he went to lie down at the end of the heap of corn: and she came softly, and uncovered his feet, and laid her down.* when Boaz had eaten and drunk, and his heart was merry, he went to lie down at the end of the heap of grain. Then she came softly and uncovered his feet and lay down.
- 8 *And it came to pass at midnight, that the man was afraid, and turned himself: and, behold, a woman lay at his feet.* At midnight the man was startled and turned over, and a woman lay at his feet!
- 9 *And he said, Who art thou? And she answered, I am Ruth thine handmaid: spread therefore thy skirt over thine handmaid; for thou art a near kinsman.* He said, "Who are you?" And she answered, "I am Ruth, your servant. Spread your wings over your servant, for you are a redeemer."

- 10 *And he said, Blessed be thou of the LORD, my daughter: for thou hast shewed more kindness in the latter end than at the beginning, inasmuch as thou followedst not young men, whether poor or rich.* he said, "May You be blessed by the LORD, my daughter. You have made this last kindness greater than the first in that You have not gone after young men, whether poor or rich.
- 11 *And now, my daughter, fear not; I will do to thee all that thou requirest: for all the city of my people doth know that thou art a virtuous woman.* now, my daughter, do not be afraid. I will do for You all that You ask, for all my fellow townspeople know that You are a worthy woman.
- 12 *And now it is true that I am thy near kinsman: howbeit there is a kinsman nearer than I.* now it is true that I am a redeemer. Yet there is a redeemer nearer than I.
- 13 *Tarry this night, and it shall be in the morning, that if he will perform unto thee the part of a kinsman, well; let him do the kinsman's part: but if he will not do the part of a kinsman to thee, then will I do the part of a kinsman to thee, as the LORD liveth: lie down until the morning.* Remain tonight, and in the morning, if He will redeem You, good; let Him do it. But if He is not willing to redeem You, then, as the LORD lives, I will redeem You. Lie down until the morning."
- 14 *And she lay at his feet until the morning: and she rose up before one could know another. And he said, Let it not be known that a woman came into the floor.* So she lay at his feet until the morning, but arose before one could recognize another. And he said, "Let it not be known that the woman came to the threshing floor."
- 15 *Also he said, Bring the vail that thou hast upon thee, and hold it. And when she held it, he measured six measures of barley, and laid it on her: and she went into the city.* he said, "Bring the garment you are wearing and hold it out." So she held it. He measured out six measures of barley and put it on her. Then she went into the city.
- 16 *And when she came to her mother in law, she said, Who art thou, my daughter? And she told her all that the man had done to her.* when she came to her mother-in-law, she said, "Who are you, my daughter?" Then she told her all that the man had done for her,

- 17 *And she said, These six measures of barley gave he me; for he said to me, Go not empty unto thy mother in law.* saying, "These six measures of barley he gave to me, for he said to me, 'You must not go back empty-handed to your mother-in-law.' "
- 18 *Then said she, Sit still, my daughter, until thou know how the matter will fall: for the man will not be in rest, until he have finished the thing this day.* She replied, "Wait, my daughter, until you learn how the matter turns out, for the man will not rest but will settle the matter today."

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ruth 1:9; 1 Tim 5:8; Ps 128:2; 1 Tim 5:14; 1 Cor 7:36

v2 — Deut 25:5-10; Ruth 2:20-23

v3 — 2 Sam 14:2; 1 Tim 2:9-10; Esth 5:1

v7 — Judg 19:6; Esth 1:10; Judg 19:9; 2 Sam 13:28

v9 — Ezek 16:8; Ruth 2:20; Ruth 3:12; Ruth 2:10-13

v10 — Ruth 2:20; 1 Cor 13:4-5; Ruth 2:4; Ruth 1:8

v11 — Prov 31:29-31; Prov 31:10; Prov 12:4

v12 — Ruth 4:1; 1 Thess 4:6

v13 — Ruth 4:5; Jer 4:2; Ruth 2:20; Deut 25:5-9

v14 — 2 Cor 8:21; Rom 14:16

v18 — Ps 37:3-5; Isa 28:16

Chapter 4

Boaz confronts the nearer kinsman at the city gate; the man declines to redeem when he learns Ruth is part of the transaction. Boaz publicly takes Ruth as his wife, and the LORD gives her a son — Obed, the father of Jesse, the father of David.

- 1 *Then went Boaz up to the gate, and sat him down there: and, behold, the kinsman of whom Boaz spake came by; unto whom he said, Ho, such a one! turn aside, sit down here. And he turned aside, and sat down.* Now Boaz had gone up to the gate and sat down there. And the redeemer, of whom Boaz had spoken, came by. So Boaz said, "Turn aside, friend; sit down here." And he turned aside and sat down.
- 2 *And he took ten men of the elders of the city, and said, Sit ye down here. And they sat down.* he took ten men of the elders of the city and said, "Sit down here." So they sat down.
- 3 *And he said unto the kinsman, Naomi, that is come again out of the country of Moab, selleth a parcel of land, which was our brother Elimelech's:* Then he said to the redeemer, "Naomi, who has come back from the country of Moab, is selling the parcel of land that belonged to our relative Elimelech.
- 4 *And I thought to advertise thee, saying, Buy it before the inhabitants, and before the elders of my people. If thou wilt redeem it, redeem it: but if thou wilt not redeem it, then tell me, that I may know: for there is none to redeem it beside thee; and I am after thee. And he said, I will redeem it.* So I thought I would tell you of it and say, 'Buy it in the presence of those sitting here and in the presence of the elders of my people.' If you will redeem it, redeem it. But if you will not, tell me, that I may know, for there is no one besides you to redeem it. I come after you." And he said, "I will redeem it."
- 5 *Then said Boaz, What day thou buyest the field of the hand of Naomi, thou must buy it also of Ruth the Moabitess, the wife of the dead, to raise up the name of the dead upon his inheritance.* Then Boaz said, "The day you buy the field from the hand of Naomi, you also acquire Ruth the Moabitess, the widow of the dead, in order to perpetuate the name of the dead in his inheritance."
- 6 *And the kinsman said, I cannot redeem it for myself, lest I mar mine own inheritance: redeem thou my right to thyself; for I cannot redeem it.* Then the redeemer said, "I cannot redeem it for myself, lest I impair my own inheritance. Take my right of redemption yourself, for I cannot redeem it."

- 7 *Now this was the manner in former time in Israel concerning redeeming and concerning changing, for to confirm all things; a man plucked off his shoe, and gave it to his neighbour: and this was a testimony in Israel.* Now this was the custom in former times in Israel concerning redeeming and exchanging: to confirm a transaction, the one drew off his sandal and gave it to the other, and this was the manner of attesting in Israel.
- 8 *Therefore the kinsman said unto Boaz, Buy it for thee. So he drew off his shoe.* So when the redeemer said to Boaz, "Buy it for yourself," he drew off his sandal.
- 9 *And Boaz said unto the elders, and unto all the people, Ye are witnesses this day, that I have bought all that was Elimelech's, and all that was Chilion's and Mahlon's, of the hand of Naomi.* Then Boaz said to the elders and all the people, "You are witnesses this day that I have bought from the hand of Naomi all that belonged to Elimelech and all that belonged to Chilion and to Mahlon.
- 10 *Moreover Ruth the Moabite, the wife of Mahlon, have I purchased to be my wife, to raise up the name of the dead upon his inheritance, that the name of the dead be not cut off from among his brethren, and from the gate of his place: ye are witnesses this day.* Also Ruth the Moabite, the widow of Mahlon, I have bought to be my wife, to perpetuate the name of the dead in his inheritance, that the name of the dead may not be cut off from among his brothers and from the gate of his native place. You are witnesses this day."
- 11 *And all the people that were in the gate, and the elders, said, We are witnesses. The LORD make the woman that is come into thine house like Rachel and like Leah, which two did build the house of Israel: and do thou worthily in Ephrathah, and be famous in Bethlehem:* Then all the people who were at the gate and the elders said, "We are witnesses. May the LORD make the woman, who is coming into your house, like Rachel and Leah, who together built up the house of Israel. May You act worthily in Ephrathah and be renowned in Bethlehem,
- 12 *And let thy house be like the house of Pharez, whom Tamar bare unto Judah, of the seed which the LORD shall give thee of this young woman.* may Your house be like the house of Pharez, whom Tamar bore to Judah, because of the seed that the LORD will give You by this young woman."

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| 13 | <i>So Boaz took Ruth, and she was his wife: and when he went in unto her, the LORD gave her conception, and she bare a son.</i> | So Boaz took Ruth. She became his wife. And he went in to her. The LORD gave her conception. She bore a son. |
| 14 | <i>And the women said unto Naomi, Blessed be the LORD, which hath not left thee this day without a kinsman, that his name may be famous in Israel.</i> | Then the women said to Naomi, "Blessed be the LORD, Who has not left you this day without a redeemer, and may His name be renowned in Israel! |
| 15 | <i>And he shall be unto thee a restorer of thy life, and a nourisher of thine old age: for thy daughter in law, which loveth thee, which is better to thee than seven sons, hath born him.</i> | He shall be to You a restorer of life and a nourisher of Your old age, for Your daughter-in-law who loves You, who is more to You than seven sons, has given birth to Him." |
| 16 | <i>And Naomi took the child, and laid it in her bosom, and became nurse unto it.</i> | Then Naomi took the child and laid him on her lap and became his nurse. |
| 17 | <i>And the women her neighbours gave it a name, saying, There is a son born to Naomi; and they called his name Obed: he is the father of Jesse, the father of David.</i> | the women of the neighborhood gave him a name, saying, "A son has been born to Naomi." They named him Obed. He was the father of Jesse, the father of David. |
| 18 | <i>Now these are the generations of Pharez: Pharez begat Hezron,</i> | Now these are the generations of Pharez: Pharez begat Hezron, |
| 19 | <i>And Hezron begat Ram, and Ram begat Amminadab,</i> | Hezron begat Ram, Ram begat Amminadab, |
| 20 | <i>And Amminadab begat Nahshon, and Nahshon begat Salmon,</i> | Amminadab begat Nahshon, Nahshon begat Salmon, |
| 21 | <i>And Salmon begat Boaz, and Boaz begat Obed,</i> | Salmon begat Boaz, Boaz begat Obed, |
| 22 | <i>And Obed begat Jesse, and Jesse begat David.</i> | Obed begat Jesse, and Jesse begat David. |

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

advertise — To inform or advise — in the KJV, 'I will advertise thee' means 'I will tell you' or 'I will give you counsel.'

Leah (*LEE-ah*) — Jacob's first wife, Laban's older daughter — mother of six of the twelve tribal ancestors and of Dinah; her name may mean 'weary.'

Pharez (*FAIR-ez*) — Twin son of Judah and Tamar — ancestor of King David and of Jesus; his name means 'breach' because he broke out first from the womb unexpectedly.

Rachel (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 25:7; Ruth 3:12

v2 — Prov 31:23; 1 Kgs 21:8

v5 — Deut 25:5-6; Matt 22:24; Gen 38:8

v11 — Gen 29:32-30:24; Mic 5:2; Matt 2:6; Ps 127:3-5

v12 — Gen 38:29

v13 — Gen 29:31; Ps 127:3; Gen 33:5; Ruth 3:11

v14 — Matt 1:5-20; Luke 1:58; Gen 12:2

v15 — Isa 46:4; Ps 55:22; Gen 45:11; Ruth 2:11-12

v18 — Matt 1:3-6; 1 Chr 2:4-8

1 Samuel

Author: Anonymous — possibly Samuel wrote portions (cf. 1 Chr 29:29), with later prophetic editors compiling the whole. Samuel could not have written the account of his own death (ch. 25).

Date written: Core material from Samuel's lifetime (c. 1050 BC); final compilation likely c. 900–700 BC.

Written to: The nation of Israel, to record the transition from the age of judges to the age of kings.

Setting: Israel is a loose tribal confederation under failing priestly leadership (Eli). The Philistines are the dominant regional power. The people are about to demand a king, and God will give them one — first Saul, then David.

Where this sits historically: c. 1100–1010 BC, covering the end of the judges era through the deaths of Samuel and Saul; Philistia is Israel's dominant rival; Egypt is in decline.

Contemporaries: Egypt's 21st dynasty (Tanite period); the Philistine pentapolis at its peak; Phoenicia organizing under Tyre and Sidon. Samuel, Saul, and the young David himself are the era's leading figures.

Big themes:

- The failure of man's king — Saul begins with promise but ends rejected; human initiative and God's anointing are not the same thing
- God's sovereign choice — He rejects Saul and chooses David while he is still a shepherd boy; the LORD looks on the heart
- Samuel — prophet, priest, and judge, the last and greatest of the judges, who bridges two eras of Israel's history
- Faith against impossible odds — David and Goliath (ch. 17) is the defining image of trusting God when the human situation is hopeless
- The ark — its capture by the Philistines and eventual return shows that God's glory cannot be taken or contained by force

Key passages: 1 Sam 2:2; 8:7; 13:14; 16:7; 17:45

How it fits: 1 Samuel completes what Judges left unresolved — Israel needs leadership, but not the kind they think. Saul's failure clears the way for David, whose covenant with God in 2 Samuel 7 becomes the backbone of all OT messianic hope.

Psalms tied to this book:

| Psalm | Event | Reference |

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| Ps 59 | David in Saul's house, men sent to kill him | 1 Sam 19 |

| Ps 34 / 56 | Feigning madness before Achish | 1 Sam 21 |

| Ps 57 / 142 | Hiding in the cave of Adullam | 1 Sam 22 |

| Ps 52 | Doeg the Edomite betrays David | 1 Sam 22 |

| Ps 54 | Ziphites betray David to Saul | 1 Sam 23 |

Chapter 1

Hannah, one of Elkanah's two wives, was barren and wept bitterly before the LORD at Shiloh, vowing that if He gave her a son she would dedicate him to God. The LORD remembered her, and she bore a son named Samuel.

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| 1 | <i>Now there was a certain man of Ramathaimzophim, of mount Ephraim, and his name was Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Elihu, the son of Tohu, the son of Zuph, an Ephrathite:</i> | There was a certain man of Ramathaim-zophim, of the hill country of Ephraim, whose name was Elkanah the son of Jeroham, son of Elihu, son of Tohu, son of Zuph, an Ephraimite. |
| 2 | <i>And he had two wives; the name of the one was Hannah, and the name of the other Peninnah: and Peninnah had children, but Hannah had no children.</i> | He had two wives. The name of the one was Hannah, and the name of the other Peninnah. Peninnah had children, but Hannah had no children. |
- **NAME NOTE** — **Hannah** (HAN-ah) — "grace, favor" — *The barren wife of Elkanah who prayed with such intensity at the tabernacle that Eli thought her drunk. God answered her prayer with a son — Samuel — whom she dedicated to the LORD's service. Her prayer of thanksgiving (2:1–10) foreshadows Mary's Magnificat.*
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| 3 | <i>And this man went up out of his city yearly to worship and to sacrifice unto the LORD of hosts in Shiloh. And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, the priests of the LORD, were there.</i> | Now this man used to go up year by year from his city to worship and to sacrifice to the LORD of hosts at Shiloh, where the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were priests of the LORD. |
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- **NAME NOTE** — **Eli** (EE-ly) — "ascended" — *The high priest and judge of Israel at Shiloh. Though personally devout, he failed to restrain his corrupt sons Hophni and Phinehas, and God's judgment fell on his house. He died at 98 when he heard the ark of God had been captured.*

- 4 *And when the time was that Elkanah offered, he gave to Peninnah his wife, and to all her sons and her daughters, portions:* On the day when Elkanah sacrificed, He would give portions to Peninnah his wife and to all her sons and daughters.
- 5 *But unto Hannah he gave a worthy portion; for he loved Hannah: but the LORD had shut up her womb.* But to Hannah he gave a double portion, because he loved her, though the LORD had closed her womb.
- 6 *And her adversary also provoked her sore, for to make her fret, because the LORD had shut up her womb.* Her rival used to provoke her grievously to irritate her, because the LORD had closed her womb.
- 7 *And as he did so year by year, when she went up to the house of the LORD, so she provoked her; therefore she wept, and did not eat.* So it went on year after year. As often as she went up to the house of the LORD, she used to provoke her. Therefore Hannah wept and would not eat.
- 8 *Then said Elkanah her husband to her, Hannah, why weepest thou? and why eatest thou not? and why is thy heart grieved? am not I better to thee than ten sons?* Elkanah, her husband, said to her, "Hannah, why do you weep? And why do you not eat? And why is your heart sad? Am I not more to you than ten sons?"
- 9 *So Hannah rose up after they had eaten in Shiloh, and after they had drunk. Now Eli the priest sat upon a seat by a post of the temple of the LORD.* After they had eaten and drunk in Shiloh, Hannah rose. Now Eli the priest was sitting on the seat beside the doorpost of the temple of the LORD.
- 10 *And she was in bitterness of soul, and prayed unto the LORD, and wept sore.* She was deeply distressed and prayed to the LORD and wept bitterly.

- 11 *And she vowed a vow, and said, O LORD of hosts, if thou wilt indeed look on the affliction of thine handmaid, and remember me, and not forget thine handmaid, but wilt give unto thine handmaid a man child, then I will give him unto the LORD all the days of his life, and there shall no razor come upon his head.* She vowed a vow and said, "O LORD of hosts, if You will indeed look on the affliction of Your servant and remember me and not forget Your servant, but will give to Your servant a son, then I will give Him to the LORD all the days of His life, and no razor shall touch His head."
- 12 *And it came to pass, as she continued praying before the LORD, that Eli marked her mouth.* As she continued praying before the LORD, Eli observed her mouth.
- 13 *Now Hannah, she spake in her heart; only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard: therefore Eli thought she had been drunken.* Hannah was speaking in her heart; only her lips moved. Her voice was not heard. Therefore Eli took her to be a drunk woman.
- 14 *And Eli said unto her, How long wilt thou be drunken? put away thy wine from thee.* Eli said to her, "How long will you keep on being drunk? Put away your wine from you."
- 15 *And Hannah answered and said, No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit: I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but have poured out my soul before the LORD.* But Hannah answered, "No, my lord, I am a woman troubled in spirit. I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink. But I have been pouring out my soul before the LORD.
- 16 *Count not thine handmaid for a daughter of Belial: for out of the abundance of my complaint and grief have I spoken hitherto.* Do not regard Your servant as a worthless woman, for all along I have been speaking out of my great anxiety and vexation."
- 17 *Then Eli answered and said, Go in peace: and the God of Israel grant thee thy petition that thou hast asked of him.* Then Eli answered, "Go in peace, and the God of Israel grant your petition that you have made to Him."

- 18 *And she said, Let thine handmaid find grace in thy sight. So the woman went her way, and did eat, and her countenance was no more sad.* She said, "Let your servant find favor in your sight." Then the woman went her way and ate. Her countenance was no longer sad.
- 19 *And they rose up in the morning early, and worshipped before the LORD, and returned, and came to their house to Ramah: and Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and the LORD remembered her.* They rose early in the morning and worshiped before the LORD, then returned and came to their house at Ramah. And Elkanah knew Hannah his wife. The LORD remembered her.
- 20 *Wherefore it came to pass, when the time was come about after Hannah had conceived, that she bare a son, and called his name Samuel, saying, Because I have asked him of the LORD.* In due time Hannah conceived and bore a son. She called his name Samuel, for she said, "I have asked for him from the LORD."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Samuel** (SAM-yoo-el) — "heard of God" — The last judge and first prophet of the monarchy period. Dedicated to the LORD before birth, he grew up serving in the tabernacle at Shiloh. He anointed both Saul and David as king over Israel.

- 21 *And the man Elkanah, and all his house, went up to offer unto the LORD the yearly sacrifice, and his vow.* The man Elkanah and all his house went up to offer to the LORD the yearly sacrifice and to pay His vow.
- 22 *But Hannah went not up; for she said unto her husband, I will not go up until the child be weaned, and then I will bring him, that he may appear before the LORD, and there abide for ever.* But Hannah did not go up, for she said to her husband, "As soon as the child is weaned, I will bring him, so that he may appear before the LORD and dwell there forever."
- 23 *And Elkanah her husband said unto her, Do what seemeth thee good; tarry until thou have weaned him; only the LORD establish his word. And the woman abode, and gave her son suck until she weaned him.* Elkanah her husband said to her, "Do what seems best to You; wait until You have weaned Him; only may the LORD establish His word." So the woman remained and nursed her son until she weaned Him.

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| <p>24 <i>And when she had weaned him, she took him up with her, with three bullocks, and one ephah of flour, and a bottle of wine, and brought him unto the house of the LORD in Shiloh: and the child was young.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And they slew a bullock, and brought the child to Eli.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And she said, Oh my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord, I am the woman that stood by thee here, praying unto the LORD.</i></p> <p>27 <i>For this child I prayed; and the LORD hath given me my petition which I asked of him:</i></p> <p>28 <i>Therefore also I have lent him to the LORD; as long as he liveth he shall be lent to the LORD. And he worshipped the LORD there.</i></p> | <p>When she had weaned Him, she took Him up with her, along with a three-year-old bull, an ephah of flour, and a skin of wine. She brought Him to the house of the LORD at Shiloh. And the child was young.</p> <p>Then they slaughtered the bull. They brought the child to Eli.</p> <p>She said, "Oh, my lord! As You live, my lord, I am the woman who was standing here in your presence, praying to the LORD.</p> <p>For this child I prayed. The LORD has granted me my petition that I made to Him.</p> <p>Therefore I have lent Him to the LORD. As long as He lives, He is lent to the LORD." And He worshiped the LORD there.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Eli (*EE-ly*) — The high priest who raised Samuel — his sons Hophni and Phinehas were corrupt; he died when he heard the ark was captured; his name means 'my God.'

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Chr 6:34; 1 Chr 6:25-27; 1 Sam 1:19

v3 — Luke 2:41; Deut 12:5-7; Josh 18:1; Ex 23:14; Ex 34:23

v10 — Job 7:11; Job 10:1; Luke 22:44; Ps 91:15; Heb 5:7

v11 — Judg 13:5; Num 6:5; Gen 29:32; Eccl 5:4; Gen 28:20
v13 — Rom 8:26; Gen 24:42-45; Acts 2:13
v15 — Ps 62:8; Lam 2:19; Ps 42:4; Ps 143:6; Ps 142:2-3
v17 — Mark 5:34; Judg 18:6; Ps 20:3-5; 2 Kgs 5:19; 1 Sam 25:35
v18 — Ruth 2:13; Rom 15:13; Eccl 9:7; Gen 33:15; John 16:24
v19 — Gen 21:1; 1 Sam 1:11; Gen 30:22; Gen 4:1
v20 — Gen 41:51-52; Matt 1:21; Ex 2:10; Ex 2:22
v24 — Num 15:9-10; Josh 18:1; 1 Sam 4:3-4; Deut 12:5-6
v27 — 1 John 5:15; Ps 118:5; Matt 7:7; Ps 66:19-20; 1 Sam 1:11-13

Chapter 2

Hannah sang a prayer of thanksgiving for Samuel's birth, praising the LORD who raises the poor. Meanwhile, Eli's sons Hophni and Phinehas were corrupt priests; a man of God prophesied the end of Eli's house.

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| <p>1 <i>And Hannah prayed, and said, My heart rejoiceth in the LORD, mine horn is exalted in the LORD: my mouth is enlarged over mine enemies; because I rejoice in thy salvation.</i></p> | <p>Hannah prayed and said, "My heart exults in the LORD; my strength is exalted in the LORD. My mouth derides my enemies, because I rejoice in Your salvation.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>There is none holy as the LORD: for there is none beside thee: neither is there any rock like our God.</i></p> | <p>There is none holy like the LORD; there is none besides You; there is no rock like our God.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Talk no more so exceeding proudly; let not arrogancy come out of your mouth: for the LORD is a God of knowledge, and by him actions are weighed.</i></p> | <p>Talk no more so very proudly, let not arrogance come from Your mouth; for the LORD is a God of knowledge, and by Him actions are weighed.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The bows of the mighty men are broken, and they that stumbled are girded with strength.</i></p> | <p>The bows of the mighty are broken, but the feeble bind on strength.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>They that were full have hired out themselves for bread; and they that were hungry ceased: so that the barren hath born seven; and she that hath many children is waxed feeble.</i></p> | <p>Those who were full have hired themselves out for bread, but those who were hungry have ceased to hunger. The barren has borne seven. But She who has many children is forlorn.</p> |

- 6 *The LORD killeth, and maketh alive: he bringeth down to the grave, and bringeth up.* The LORD kills and brings to life; He brings down to hell and raises up.
- 7 *The LORD maketh poor, and maketh rich: he bringeth low, and lifteth up.* The LORD makes poor and makes rich; He brings low and He exalts.
- 8 *He raiseth up the poor out of the dust, and lifteth up the beggar from the dunghill, to set them among princes, and to make them inherit the throne of glory: for the pillars of the earth are the LORD'S, and he hath set the world upon them.* He raises up the poor from the dust; He lifts the needy from the ash heap to make them sit with princes and inherit a seat of honor. For the pillars of the earth are the LORD's, and on them He has set the world.
- 9 *He will keep the feet of his saints, and the wicked shall be silent in darkness; for by strength shall no man prevail.* He will guard the feet of his faithful ones, but the wicked shall be cut off in darkness, for not by might shall a man prevail.
- 10 *The adversaries of the LORD shall be broken to pieces; out of heaven shall he thunder upon them: the LORD shall judge the ends of the earth; and he shall give strength unto his king, and exalt the horn of his anointed.* The adversaries of the LORD shall be shattered; against them He will thunder in heaven. The LORD will judge the ends of the earth; He will give strength to His king and exalt the power of His anointed."
- 11 *And Elkanah went to Ramah to his house. And the child did minister unto the LORD before Eli the priest.* Then Elkanah went home to Ramah. And the boy was ministering to the LORD in the presence of Eli the priest.
- 12 *Now the sons of Eli were sons of Belial; they knew not the LORD.* Now the sons of Eli were worthless men. They did not know the LORD.
- 13 *And the priests' custom with the people was, that, when any man offered sacrifice, the priest's servant came, while the flesh was in seething, with a fleshhook of three teeth in his hand;* The custom of the priests with the people was this: when any man offered sacrifice, the priest's servant would come, while the meat was boiling, with a three-pronged fork in his hand,

- 14 *And he struck it into the pan, or kettle, or caldron, or pot; all that the fleshhook brought up the priest took for himself. So they did in Shiloh unto all the Israelites that came thither.* He would thrust it into the pan or kettle or cauldron or pot. All that the fork brought up the priest would take for himself. This is what they did at Shiloh to all the Israelites who came there.
- 15 *Also before they burnt the fat, the priest's servant came, and said to the man that sacrificed, Give flesh to roast for the priest; for he will not have sodden flesh of thee, but raw.* Moreover, before the fat was burned, the priest's servant would come and say to the man who was sacrificing, "Give meat for the priest to roast, for he will not accept boiled meat from you but only raw."
- 16 *And if any man said unto him, Let them not fail to burn the fat presently, and then take as much as thy soul desireth; then he would answer him, Nay; but thou shalt give it me now: and if not, I will take it by force.* If the man said to him, "Let the fat be burned first, and then take as much as you wish," he would say, "No, you must give it now, and if not, I will take it by force."
- 17 *Wherefore the sin of the young men was very great before the LORD: for men abhorred the offering of the LORD.* Thus the sin of the young men was very great in the sight of the LORD, for the men treated the offering of the LORD with contempt.
- 18 *But Samuel ministered before the LORD, being a child, girded with a linen ephod.* Samuel was ministering before the LORD, a boy clothed with a linen ephod.
- 19 *Moreover his mother made him a little coat, and brought it to him from year to year, when she came up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice.* His mother used to make for Him a little robe and take it to Him each year when she went up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice.
- 20 *And Eli blessed Elkanah and his wife, and said, The LORD give thee seed of this woman for the loan which is lent to the LORD. And they went unto their own home.* Then Eli would bless Elkanah and his wife, and say, "May the LORD give You children by this woman in place of the one she asked of the LORD." So then they would return to their home.

- 21 *And the LORD visited Hannah, so that she conceived, and bare three sons and two daughters. And the child Samuel grew before the LORD.* Indeed the LORD visited Hannah. She conceived and bore three sons and two daughters. And the boy Samuel grew in the presence of the LORD.
- 22 *Now Eli was very old, and heard all that his sons did unto all Israel; and how they lay with the women that assembled at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* Now Eli was very old. He kept hearing all that his sons were doing to all Israel, and how they lay with the women who were serving at the entrance to the tent of meeting.
- 23 *And he said unto them, Why do ye such things? for I hear of your evil dealings by all this people.* He said to them, "Why do you do such things? For I hear of your evil dealings from all these people.
- 24 *Nay, my sons; for it is no good report that I hear: ye make the LORD'S people to transgress.* No, my sons; it is no good report that I hear the LORD's people spreading abroad.
- 25 *If one man sin against another, the judge shall judge him: but if a man sin against the LORD, who shall intreat for him? Notwithstanding they hearkened not unto the voice of their father, because the LORD would have them slain.* If someone sins against a man, God will mediate for Him, but if someone sins against the LORD, Who can intercede for Him?" But they would not listen to the voice of their father, for it was the will of the LORD to put them to death.
- 26 *And the child Samuel grew on, and was in favour both with the LORD, and also with men.* Now the boy Samuel continued to grow both in stature and in favor with the LORD and also with men.
- 27 *And there came a man of God unto Eli, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Did I plainly appear unto the house of thy father, when they were in Egypt in Pharaoh's house?* There came a man of God to Eli and said to him, "Thus says the LORD, 'Did I indeed reveal myself to the house of Your father when they were in Egypt subject to the house of Pharaoh?

- 28 *And did I choose him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to offer upon mine altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me? and did I give unto the house of thy father all the offerings made by fire of the children of Israel?* Did I choose Him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to go up to my altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me? I gave to the house of Your father all my offerings by fire from the people of Israel.
- 29 *Wherefore kick ye at my sacrifice and at mine offering, which I have commanded in my habitation; and honourest thy sons above me, to make yourselves fat with the chiefest of all the offerings of Israel my people?* Why then do You scorn my sacrifices and my offerings that I commanded for my dwelling, and honor Your sons above me by fattening yourselves on the choicest parts of every offering of my people Israel?'
- 30 *Wherefore the LORD God of Israel saith, I said indeed that thy house, and the house of thy father, should walk before me for ever: but now the LORD saith, Be it far from me; for them that honour me I will honour, and they that despise me shall be lightly esteemed.* Therefore the LORD, the God of Israel, declares: 'I promised that Your house and the house of Your father should go in and out before me forever,' but now the LORD declares: 'Far be it from me, for those who honor me I will honor, and those who despise me shall be treated with contempt.
- 31 *Behold, the days come, that I will cut off thine arm, and the arm of thy father's house, that there shall not be an old man in thine house.* See, the days are coming when I will cut off Your strength and the strength of Your father's house, so that there will not be an old man in Your house.
- 32 *And thou shalt see an enemy in my habitation, in all the wealth which God shall give Israel: and there shall not be an old man in thine house for ever.* Then in distress You will look on all the prosperity that will be bestowed on Israel, and there shall not be an old man in Your house forever.

- 33 *And the man of thine, whom I shall not cut off from mine altar, shall be to consume thine eyes, and to grieve thine heart: and all the increase of thine house shall die in the flower of their age.* The only one of You whom I shall not cut off from my altar shall be spared to weep His eyes out and to grieve His heart. All the descendants of Your house shall die in the flower of their age.
- 34 *And this shall be a sign unto thee, that shall come upon thy two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas; in one day they shall die both of them.* This shall be the sign to You that will come upon Your two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas: both of them shall die on the same day.
- 35 *And I will raise me up a faithful priest, that shall do according to that which is in mine heart and in my mind: and I will build him a sure house; and he shall walk before mine anointed for ever.* I will raise up for myself a faithful priest, who shall do according to what is in my heart and in my mind. And I will build Him a sure house. He shall go in and out before my anointed forever.
- 36 *And it shall come to pass, that every one that is left in thine house shall come and crouch to him for a piece of silver and a morsel of bread, and shall say, Put me, I pray thee, into one of the priests' offices, that I may eat a piece of bread.* Everyone who is left in Your house shall come to implore Him for a piece of silver or a loaf of bread and shall say, "Please put me in one of the priests' places, that I may eat a morsel of bread.""

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 1:46-56; Ps 13:5; Isa 12:2-3; Ps 92:10; Phil 4:6

v2 — 2 Sam 22:32; Isa 44:6; Ps 86:8; Ex 15:11; 1 Pet 1:16

v3 — Prov 8:13; 1 Kgs 8:39; Prov 24:12; Jude 1:15-16; Heb 4:12
 v5 — Luke 1:53; Jer 15:9; Ps 113:9; Ps 34:10; Luke 16:25
 v6 — Deut 32:39; Isa 26:19; Jonah 2:2-6; 2 Kgs 5:7; Rev 1:18
 v7 — Ps 75:7; Job 5:11; Deut 8:17-18; Jas 4:10; Job 1:21
 v8 — Ps 113:7-8; Dan 2:48; Jas 2:5; Dan 6:3; Eccl 4:14
 v9 — Ps 121:3; Ps 91:11-12; Ps 33:16-17; 1 Pet 1:5; Job 5:24
 v21 — Luke 2:40; Gen 21:1; 1 Sam 3:19; 1 Sam 2:26; Luke 1:80
 v25 — 1 Sam 3:14; Heb 10:26; Josh 11:20; Num 15:30; 1 Tim 2:5
 v26 — Luke 2:52; Luke 2:40; Acts 2:47; Luke 1:80; 1 Sam 2:21
 v30 — John 12:26; Jer 18:9-10; Prov 3:9-10; Mal 1:6; 2 Chr 15:2

Chapter 3

The LORD called the boy Samuel three times in the night at Shiloh, and Eli told him to answer. God revealed to Samuel that He would judge Eli's house for the iniquity of his sons, and all Israel recognized Samuel as a prophet.

- 1 *And the child Samuel ministered unto the LORD before Eli. And the word of the LORD was precious in those days; there was no open vision.* Now the boy Samuel was ministering to the LORD in the presence of Eli. And the word of the LORD was rare in those days; there was no frequent vision.
- 2 *And it came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see;* At that time Eli, whose eyesight had begun to grow dim so that he could not see, was lying down in his own place.
- 3 *And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was, and Samuel was laid down to sleep;* The lamp of God had not yet gone out, and Samuel was lying down in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was.
- 4 *That the LORD called Samuel: and he answered, Here am I.* Then the LORD called Samuel. He said, "Here I am!"
- 5 *And he ran unto Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou calledst me. And he said, I called not; lie down again. And he went and lay down.* He ran to Eli and said, "Here I am, for you called me." But he said, "I did not call; lie down again." So he went and lay down.

- 6 *And the LORD called yet again, Samuel. And Samuel arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And he answered, I called not, my son; lie down again.* The LORD called again, "Samuel!" And Samuel arose and went to Eli and said, "Here I am, for you called me." But he said, "I did not call, my son; lie down again."
- 7 *Now Samuel did not yet know the LORD, neither was the word of the LORD yet revealed unto him.* Now Samuel did not yet know the LORD, and the word of the LORD had not yet been revealed to Him.
- 8 *And the LORD called Samuel again the third time. And he arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And Eli perceived that the LORD had called the child.* The LORD called Samuel again the third time. And he arose and went to Eli and said, "Here I am, for you called me." Then Eli saw that the LORD was calling the boy.
- 9 *Therefore Eli said unto Samuel, Go, lie down: and it shall be, if he call thee, that thou shalt say, Speak, LORD; for thy servant heareth. So Samuel went and lay down in his place.* Therefore Eli said to Samuel, "Go, lie down, and if he calls you, you shall say, 'Speak, LORD, for your servant hears.' " So Samuel went and lay down in his place.
- 10 *And the LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, Samuel, Samuel. Then Samuel answered, Speak; for thy servant heareth.* The LORD came and stood, calling as at other times, "Samuel! Samuel!" And Samuel said, "Speak, for your servant hears."
- 11 *And the LORD said to Samuel, Behold, I will do a thing in Israel, at which both the ears of every one that heareth it shall tingle.* Then the LORD said to Samuel, "See, I am about to do a thing in Israel at which both ears of everyone who hears it will tingle.
- 12 *In that day I will perform against Eli all things which I have spoken concerning his house: when I begin, I will also make an end.* On that day I will fulfill against Eli all that I have spoken concerning his house, from beginning to end.

- 13 *For I have told him that I will judge his house for ever for the iniquity which he knoweth; because his sons made themselves vile, and he restrained them not.* I declare to him that I am about to punish his house forever, for the iniquity that he knew, because his sons were blaspheming God. He did not restrain them.
- 14 *And therefore I have sworn unto the house of Eli, that the iniquity of Eli's house shall not be purged with sacrifice nor offering for ever.* Therefore I swear to the house of Eli that the iniquity of Eli's house shall not be atoned for by sacrifice or offering forever."
- 15 *And Samuel lay until the morning, and opened the doors of the house of the LORD. And Samuel feared to shew Eli the vision.* Samuel lay until morning; then he opened the doors of the house of the LORD. And Samuel was afraid to tell the vision to Eli.
- 16 *Then Eli called Samuel, and said, Samuel, my son. And he answered, Here am I.* But Eli called Samuel and said, "Samuel, my son." And he said, "Here I am."
- 17 *And he said, What is the thing that the LORD hath said unto thee? I pray thee hide it not from me: God do so to thee, and more also, if thou hide any thing from me of all the things that he said unto thee.* Eli said, "What was it that he told you? Do not hide it from me. May God do so to you and more also if you hide anything from me of all that He told you."
- 18 *And Samuel told him every whit, and hid nothing from him. And he said, It is the LORD: let him do what seemeth him good.* So Samuel told him everything and hid nothing from him. And He said, "It is the LORD. Let Him do what seems good to Him."
- 19 *And Samuel grew, and the LORD was with him, and did let none of his words fall to the ground.* Samuel grew. The LORD was with Him and let none of His words fall to the ground.
- 20 *And all Israel from Dan even to Beersheba knew that Samuel was established to be a prophet of the LORD.* All Israel from Dan to Beersheba knew that Samuel was established as a prophet of the LORD.

21	<i>And the LORD appeared again in Shiloh: for the LORD revealed himself to Samuel in Shiloh by the word of the LORD.</i>	The LORD appeared again at Shiloh, for the LORD revealed Himself to Samuel at Shiloh by the word of the LORD.
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Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Amos 8:11-12; Ps 74:9; 1 Sam 3:21; 1 Sam 2:11
- v2 — 1 Sam 4:15
- v3 — Ps 27:4; Lev 24:2-4
- v7 — Acts 19:2
- v9 — Ex 20:19; Isa 6:8; Ps 85:8
- v11 — Hab 1:5; Acts 13:41; 2 Kgs 21:12; Jer 19:3
- v13 — Prov 19:18; Matt 10:37; 1 Sam 2:12; 1 Sam 2:17; Prov 23:13-14
- v14 — Isa 22:14
- v18 — Isa 39:8; Job 2:10
- v19 — Gen 39:2; 1 Sam 9:6; Luke 2:52; 1 Kgs 8:56; 2 Tim 4:22
- v20 — Judg 20:1
- v21 — 1 Sam 3:1; Gen 12:7; 1 Sam 3:4

Chapter 4

Israel was defeated by the Philistines at the battle of Aphek, and the ark of the covenant was captured. Hophni and Phinehas were killed; when Eli heard the news, he fell from his seat, broke his neck, and died.

1	<i>And the word of Samuel came to all Israel. Now Israel went out against the Philistines to battle, and pitched beside Ebenezer: and the Philistines pitched in Aphek.</i>	The word of Samuel came to all Israel. Now Israel went out to battle against the Philistines. They encamped at Ebenezer, and the Philistines encamped at Aphek.
2	<i>And the Philistines put themselves in array against Israel: and when they joined battle, Israel was smitten before the Philistines: and they slew of the army in the field about four thousand men.</i>	The Philistines drew up in line against Israel, and when the battle spread, Israel was defeated before the Philistines, who killed about four thousand men on the field of battle.

- 3 *And when the people were come into the camp, the elders of Israel said, Wherefore hath the LORD smitten us to day before the Philistines? Let us fetch the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of Shiloh unto us, that, when it cometh among us, it may save us out of the hand of our enemies.* When the troops came to the camp, the elders of Israel said, "Why has the LORD defeated us today before the Philistines? Let us bring the ark of the covenant of the LORD here from Shiloh, that it may come among us and save us from the power of our enemies."
- 4 *So the people sent to Shiloh, that they might bring from thence the ark of the covenant of the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth between the cherubims: and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the ark of the covenant of God.* So the people sent to Shiloh and brought from there the ark of the covenant of the LORD of hosts, who is enthroned on the cherubim. And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the ark of the covenant of God.
- 5 *And when the ark of the covenant of the LORD came into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth rang again.* As soon as the ark of the covenant of the LORD came into the camp, all Israel gave a mighty shout, so that the earth resounded.
- 6 *And when the Philistines heard the noise of the shout, they said, What meaneth the noise of this great shout in the camp of the Hebrews? And they understood that the ark of the LORD was come into the camp.* When the Philistines heard the noise of the shouting, they said, "What does this great shouting in the camp of the Hebrews mean?" And when they learned that the ark of the LORD had come to the camp,
- 7 *And the Philistines were afraid, for they said, God is come into the camp. And they said, Woe unto us! for there hath not been such a thing heretofore.* The Philistines were afraid, for they said, "God has come into the camp." And they said, "Woe to us! For nothing like this has happened before.
- 8 *Woe unto us! who shall deliver us out of the hand of these mighty Gods? these are the Gods that smote the Egyptians with all the plagues in the wilderness.* Woe to us! Who can deliver us from the power of these mighty gods? These are the gods who struck the Egyptians with every kind of plague in the wilderness.

- 9 *Be strong, and quit yourselves like men, O ye Philistines, that ye be not servants unto the Hebrews, as they have been to you: quit yourselves like men, and fight.* Be strong and be men, O Philistines, lest You become slaves to the Hebrews as they have been slaves to You. Be men and fight."
- 10 *And the Philistines fought, and Israel was smitten, and they fled every man into his tent: and there was a very great slaughter; for there fell of Israel thirty thousand footmen.* So the Philistines fought. Israel was defeated, and every man fled to his tent. There was a very great slaughter, for thirty thousand foot soldiers of Israel fell.
- 11 *And the ark of God was taken; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain.* The ark of God was captured, and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were killed.
- 12 *And there ran a man of Benjamin out of the army, and came to Shiloh the same day with his clothes rent, and with earth upon his head.* A man of Benjamin ran from the battle line and came to Shiloh the same day, with his clothes torn and with dirt on his head.
- 13 *And when he came, lo, Eli sat upon a seat by the wayside watching: for his heart trembled for the ark of God. And when the man came into the city, and told it, all the city cried out.* When he arrived, Eli was sitting on his seat by the road watching, for his heart trembled for the ark of God. When the man came into the city and reported the news, all the city cried out.
- 14 *And when Eli heard the noise of the crying, he said, What meaneth the noise of this tumult? And the man came in hastily, and told Eli.* When Eli heard the sound of the outcry, he said, "What is the noise of this uproar?" Then the man hurried and came and told Eli.
- 15 *Now Eli was ninety and eight years old; and his eyes were dim, that he could not see.* Now Eli was ninety-eight years old. His eyes were set so that he could not see.
- 16 *And the man said unto Eli, I am he that came out of the army, and I fled to day out of the army. And he said, What is there done, my son?* The man said to Eli, "I am he who has come from the battle; I fled from the battle today." And he said, "How did it go, my son?"

- 17 *And the messenger answered and said, Israel is fled before the Philistines, and there hath been also a great slaughter among the people, and thy two sons also, Hophni and Phinehas, are dead, and the ark of God is taken.* He who brought the news answered and said, "Israel has fled before the Philistines, and there has also been a great defeat among the people. Your two sons also, Hophni and Phinehas, are dead, and the ark of God has been captured."
- 18 *And it came to pass, when he made mention of the ark of God, that he fell from off the seat backward by the side of the gate, and his neck brake, and he died: for he was an old man, and heavy. And he had judged Israel forty years.* As soon as he mentioned the ark of God, Eli fell over backward from his seat beside the gate. His neck was broken and he died, for the man was old and heavy. He had judged Israel forty years.
- 19 *And his daughter in law, Phinehas' wife, was with child, near to be delivered: and when she heard the tidings that the ark of God was taken, and that her father in law was dead, and her husband dead, she bowed herself and travailed; for her pains came upon her.* Now his daughter-in-law, the wife of Phinehas, was pregnant, about to give birth. And when she heard the news that the ark of God was captured, and that her father-in-law and her husband were dead, she bowed and gave birth, for her labor pains came upon her.
- 20 *And about the time of her death the women that stood by her said unto her, Fear not; for thou hast born a son. But she answered not, neither did she regard it.* About the time of her death the women attending her said to her, "Do not be afraid, for you have borne a son." But she did not answer or pay attention.
- 21 *And she named the child Ichabod, saying, The glory is departed from Israel: because the ark of God was taken, and because of her father in law and her husband.* She named the child Ichabod, saying, "The glory has departed from Israel!" because the ark of God had been captured and because of her father-in-law and her husband.
- 22 *And she said, The glory is departed from Israel: for the ark of God is taken.* She said, "The glory has departed from Israel, for the ark of God has been captured."

Words in this chapter:

- ark of the covenant** — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.
- cherubim** (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.
- Philistines** (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'
- Benjamin** (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Sam 29:1
- v4** — 2 Sam 6:2; Num 7:89; Ps 80:1
- v9** — 1 Cor 16:13; Judg 13:1; Eph 6:10-11; 2 Sam 10:12
- v10** — 1 Sam 4:2; Deut 28:25; Lev 26:17; 2 Kgs 14:12
- v11** — 1 Sam 2:34; Ps 78:64
- v12** — Josh 7:6
- v13** — 1 Sam 1:9
- v15** — 1 Sam 3:2
- v16** — 2 Sam 1:4
- v18** — 1 Sam 4:21-22; 1 Pet 4:17-18
- v21** — Ps 26:8; Jer 2:11; Ps 78:61; Ps 78:64; Hos 9:12

Chapter 5

The Philistines placed the captured ark in the temple of Dagon at Ashdod, and the idol fell before it. The LORD struck the people of Ashdod and then Gath and Ekron with tumors, and they urgently sought to return the ark.

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| 1 | <i>And the Philistines took the ark of God, and brought it from Ebenezer unto Ashdod.</i> | When the Philistines captured the ark of God, they brought it from Ebenezer to Ashdod. |
| 2 | <i>When the Philistines took the ark of God, they brought it into the house of Dagon, and set it by Dagon.</i> | Then the Philistines took the ark of God and brought it into the house of Dagon and set it up beside Dagon. |

- 3 *And when they of Ashdod arose early on the morrow, behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face to the earth before the ark of the LORD. And they took Dagon, and set him in his place again.* When the people of Ashdod rose early the next day, there was Dagon fallen face downward on the ground before the ark of the LORD. So they took Dagon and put Him back in His place.
- 4 *And when they arose early on the morrow morning, behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face to the ground before the ark of the LORD; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off upon the threshold; only the stump of Dagon was left to him.* But when they rose early on the next morning, Dagon had fallen face downward on the ground before the ark of the LORD, and the head of Dagon and both His hands were lying cut off on the threshold. Only the trunk of Dagon was left to Him.
- 5 *Therefore neither the priests of Dagon, nor any that come into Dagon's house, tread on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod unto this day.* This is why the priests of Dagon and all who enter the house of Dagon do not tread on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod to this day.
- 6 *But the hand of the LORD was heavy upon them of Ashdod, and he destroyed them, and smote them with emerods, even Ashdod and the coasts thereof.* The hand of the LORD was heavy against the people of Ashdod. He terrified and afflicted them with tumors, both Ashdod and its territory.
- 7 *And when the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, The ark of the God of Israel shall not abide with us: for his hand is sore upon us, and upon Dagon our god.* When the men of Ashdod saw how things were, they said, "The ark of the God of Israel must not remain with us, for His hand is hard against us and against Dagon our god."

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| <p>8 <i>They sent therefore and gathered all the lords of the Philistines unto them, and said, What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel? And they answered, Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried about unto Gath. And they carried the ark of the God of Israel about thither.</i></p> | <p>So they sent and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines and said, "What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel?" They answered, "Let the ark of the God of Israel be brought around to Gath." So they brought the ark of the God of Israel there.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And it was so, that, after they had carried it about, the hand of the LORD was against the city with a very great destruction: and he smote the men of the city, both small and great, and they had emerods in their secret parts.</i></p> | <p>But after they had brought it around, the hand of the LORD was against the city, causing a very great panic. He afflicted the men of the city, both young and old, with tumors.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Therefore they sent the ark of God to Ekron. And it came to pass, as the ark of God came to Ekron, that the Ekronites cried out, saying, They have brought about the ark of the God of Israel to us, to slay us and our people.</i></p> | <p>So they sent the ark of God to Ekron. But as soon as the ark of God came to Ekron, the people of Ekron cried out, "They have brought around to us the ark of the God of Israel to kill us and our people."</p> |
| <p>11 <i>So they sent and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines, and said, Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let it go again to his own place, that it slay us not, and our people: for there was a deadly destruction throughout all the city; the hand of God was very heavy there.</i></p> | <p>They sent therefore and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines and said, "Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let it return to its own place, that it may not kill us and our people." For there was a deathly panic throughout the whole city. The hand of God was very heavy there.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And the men that died not were smitten with the emerods: and the cry of the city went up to heaven.</i></p> | <p>The men who did not die were struck with tumors, and the cry of the city went up to heaven.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen-z*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast;

gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 7:12
- v2 — Judg 16:23
- v3 — Isa 19:1; Isa 46:1-2; Isa 46:7
- v4 — Mic 1:7
- v5 — Zeph 1:9
- v6 — 1 Sam 5:11; Deut 28:27; Ps 32:4; Ex 9:3; Acts 13:11
- v7 — Ex 12:33
- v9 — 1 Sam 5:6; Deut 2:15; 1 Sam 7:13; 1 Sam 12:15
- v11 — 1 Sam 5:6
- v12 — Ex 12:30

Chapter 6

The Philistines sent the ark back to Israel on a new cart drawn by two milk cows, with guilt offerings of golden tumors and mice. The ark came to Beth-shemesh, where the LORD struck down men who looked into it, and it was taken to Kiriath-jearim.

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| <p>1 <i>And the ark of the LORD was in the country of the Philistines seven months.</i></p> | <p>The ark of the LORD was in the country of the Philistines seven months.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, saying, What shall we do to the ark of the LORD? tell us wherewith we shall send it to his place.</i></p> | <p>The Philistines called for the priests and the diviners and said, "What shall we do with the ark of the LORD? Tell us with what we should send it to its place."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they said, If ye send away the ark of the God of Israel, send it not empty; but in any wise return him a trespass offering: then ye shall be healed, and it shall be known to you why his hand is not removed from you.</i></p> | <p>They said, "If You send away the ark of the God of Israel, do not send it empty, but by all means return Him a guilt offering. Then You will be healed. It will be known to You why His hand does not turn away from You."</p> |

- 4 *Then said they, What shall be the trespass offering which we shall return to him? They answered, Five golden emerods, and five golden mice, according to the number of the lords of the Philistines: for one plague was on you all, and on your lords.* They said, "What is the guilt offering that we shall return to Him?" They answered, "Five golden tumors and five golden mice, according to the number of the lords of the Philistines, for the same plague was on all of You and on Your lords.
- 5 *Wherefore ye shall make images of your emerods, and images of your mice that mar the land; and ye shall give glory unto the God of Israel: peradventure he will lighten his hand from off you, and from off your gods, and from off your land.* So You must make images of Your tumors and images of Your mice that ravage the land, and give glory to the God of Israel. Perhaps He will lighten His hand from over You and Your gods and Your land.
- 6 *Wherefore then do ye harden your hearts, as the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? when he had wrought wonderfully among them, did they not let the people go, and they departed?* Why should you harden your hearts as the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? After he had dealt harshly with them, did they not let the people go. They departed?
- 7 *Now therefore make a new cart, and take two milch kine, on which there hath come no yoke, and tie the kine to the cart, and bring their calves home from them:* Now then, take and prepare a new cart and two milk cows on which there has never come a yoke, and yoke the cows to the cart, but take their calves home, away from them.
- 8 *And take the ark of the LORD, and lay it upon the cart; and put the jewels of gold, which ye return him for a trespass offering, in a coffer by the side thereof; and send it away, that it may go.* Take the ark of the LORD and place it on the cart and put the golden figures, which You are returning to Him as a guilt offering, in a box at its side. Then send it off and let it go its way.

- 9 *And see, if it goeth up by the way of his own coast to Bethshemesh, then he hath done us this great evil: but if not, then we shall know that it is not his hand that smote us; it was a chance that happened to us.* Watch: if it goes up on the way to its own land, to Beth-shemesh, then it is He who has done us this great harm, but if not, then we shall know that it is not His hand that struck us; it happened to us by chance."
- 10 *And the men did so; and took two milch kine, and tied them to the cart, and shut up their calves at home:* The men did so, and took two milk cows and yoked them to the cart and shut up their calves at home.
- 11 *And they laid the ark of the LORD upon the cart, and the coffer with the mice of gold and the images of their emerods.* They put the ark of the LORD on the cart and the box with the golden mice and the images of their tumors.
- 12 *And the kine took the straight way to the way of Bethshemesh, and went along the highway, lowing as they went, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left; and the lords of the Philistines went after them unto the border of Bethshemesh.* The cows went straight in the direction of Beth-shemesh along one highway, lowing as they went. They turned neither to the right nor to the left, and the lords of the Philistines went after them as far as the border of Beth-shemesh.
- 13 *And they of Bethshemesh were reaping their wheat harvest in the valley: and they lifted up their eyes, and saw the ark, and rejoiced to see it.* Now the people of Beth-shemesh were harvesting their wheat in the valley, and when they lifted up their eyes and saw the ark, they rejoiced to see it.
- 14 *And the cart came into the field of Joshua, a Bethshemite, and stood there, where there was a great stone: and they clave the wood of the cart, and offered the kine a burnt offering unto the LORD.* The cart came into the field of Joshua of Beth-shemesh and stopped there. A large stone was there. And they split up the wood of the cart and offered the cows as a burnt offering to the LORD.

- 15 *And the Levites took down the ark of the LORD, and the coffer that was with it, wherein the jewels of gold were, and put them on the great stone: and the men of Bethshemesh offered burnt offerings and sacrificed sacrifices the same day unto the LORD.* The Levites took down the ark of the LORD and the box that was beside it, in which were the golden figures, and set them on the large stone. And the men of Beth-shemesh offered burnt offerings and sacrificed sacrifices on that day to the LORD.
- 16 *And when the five lords of the Philistines had seen it, they returned to Ekron the same day.* When the five lords of the Philistines saw it, they returned that day to Ekron.
- 17 *And these are the golden emerods which the Philistines returned for a trespass offering unto the LORD; for Ashdod one, for Gaza one, for Askalon one, for Gath one, for Ekron one;* These are the golden tumors that the Philistines returned as a guilt offering to the LORD: one for Ashdod, one for Gaza, one for Ashkelon, one for Gath, one for Ekron—
- 18 *And the golden mice, according to the number of all the cities of the Philistines belonging to the five lords, both of fenced cities, and of country villages, even unto the great stone of Abel, whereon they set down the ark of the LORD: which stone remaineth unto this day in the field of Joshua, the Bethshemite.* The golden mice, according to the number of all the cities of the Philistines belonging to the five lords, both fortified cities and unwallled villages, as far as the great stone beside which they set down the ark of the LORD. That stone is a witness to this day in the field of Joshua of Beth-shemesh.
- 19 *And he smote the men of Bethshemesh, because they had looked into the ark of the LORD, even he smote of the people fifty thousand and threescore and ten men: and the people lamented, because the LORD had smitten many of the people with a great slaughter.* He struck some of the men of Beth-shemesh, because they looked upon the ark of the LORD. He struck fifty thousand and threescore and ten men of them, and the people mourned because the LORD had struck the people with a great blow.

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| <p>20 <i>And the men of Bethshemesh said,
Who is able to stand before this holy
LORD God? and to whom shall he go
up from us?</i></p> <p>21 <i>And they sent messengers to the
inhabitants of Kirjathjearim, saying,
The Philistines have brought again
the ark of the LORD; come ye down,
and fetch it up to you.</i></p> | <p>Then the men of Beth-shemesh said,
"Who is able to stand before the
LORD, this holy God? And to whom
shall He go up away from us?"</p> <p>So they sent messengers to the
inhabitants of Kiriath-jearim, saying,
"The Philistines have returned the ark
of the LORD. Come down and take it
up to You."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

trespass offering — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

Abel (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 7:11; Gen 41:8

v4 — Josh 13:3; 1 Sam 6:17-18; Judg 3:3

v5 — Josh 7:19; 1 Sam 5:11; 1 Sam 5:6-7

v6 — Ex 8:15; Ex 7:13; Ex 14:17; Ex 9:34

v7 — 2 Sam 6:3; Num 19:2

v19 — Num 4:20; Ex 19:21; Num 4:15; 2 Sam 6:7

v20 — 2 Sam 6:9; Mal 3:2; Rev 6:17

v21 — 1 Chr 13:5-6

Chapter 7

Samuel called Israel to repentance at Mizpah, and they put away their foreign gods. When the Philistines attacked, the LORD thundered against them and Israel won the battle of Mizpah; Samuel judged Israel all his days.

- 1 *And the men of Kirjathjearim came, and fetched up the ark of the LORD, and brought it into the house of Abinadab in the hill, and sanctified Eleazar his son to keep the ark of the LORD.* The men of Kiriath-jearim came and took up the ark of the LORD and brought it to the house of Abinadab on the hill. And they consecrated His son Eleazar to have charge of the ark of the LORD.
- 2 *And it came to pass, while the ark abode in Kirjathjearim, that the time was long; for it was twenty years: and all the house of Israel lamented after the LORD.* From the day that the ark was lodged at Kiriath-jearim, a long time passed, some twenty years. All the house of Israel mourned and sought after the LORD.
- 3 *And Samuel spake unto all the house of Israel, saying, If ye do return unto the LORD with all your hearts, then put away the strange gods and Ashtaroth from among you, and prepare your hearts unto the LORD, and serve him only: and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines.* Samuel said to all the house of Israel, "If you are returning to the LORD with all Your heart, then put away the foreign gods and the Ashtaroth from among You and direct Your heart to the LORD and serve Him only. He will deliver You out of the hand of the Philistines."
- 4 *Then the children of Israel did put away Baalim and Ashtaroth, and served the LORD only.* So the people of Israel put away the Baals and the Ashtaroth. They served the LORD only.
- 5 *And Samuel said, Gather all Israel to Mizpeh, and I will pray for you unto the LORD.* Then Samuel said, "Gather all Israel at Mizpah. I will pray to the LORD for You."
- 6 *And they gathered together to Mizpeh, and drew water, and poured it out before the LORD, and fasted on that day, and said there, We have sinned against the LORD. And Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpeh.* So they gathered at Mizpah and drew water and poured it out before the LORD and fasted on that day and said there, "We have sinned against the LORD." And Samuel judged the people of Israel at Mizpah.

- 7 *And when the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together to Mizpeh, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. And when the children of Israel heard it, they were afraid of the Philistines.* Now when the Philistines heard that the people of Israel had gathered at Mizpah, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. And when the people of Israel heard of it, they were afraid of the Philistines.
- 8 *And the children of Israel said to Samuel, Cease not to cry unto the LORD our God for us, that he will save us out of the hand of the Philistines.* The people of Israel said to Samuel, "Do not cease to cry out to the LORD our God for us, that He may save us from the hand of the Philistines."
- 9 *And Samuel took a sucking lamb, and offered it for a burnt offering wholly unto the LORD: and Samuel cried unto the LORD for Israel; and the LORD heard him.* So Samuel took a nursing lamb and offered it as a whole burnt offering to the LORD. And Samuel cried out to the LORD for Israel. The LORD answered Him.
- 10 *And as Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines drew near to battle against Israel: but the LORD thundered with a great thunder on that day upon the Philistines, and discomfited them; and they were smitten before Israel.* As Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines drew near to attack Israel. But the LORD thundered with a mighty sound that day against the Philistines and threw them into confusion. They were defeated before Israel.
- 11 *And the men of Israel went out of Mizpeh, and pursued the Philistines, and smote them, until they came under Bethcar.* The men of Israel went out from Mizpah and pursued the Philistines and struck them, as far as below Beth-car.
- 12 *Then Samuel took a stone, and set it between Mizpeh and Shen, and called the name of it Ebenezer, saying, Hitherto hath the LORD helped us.* Then Samuel took a stone and set it up between Mizpah and Shen and called its name Ebenezer, for He said, "Till now the LORD has helped us."

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| <p>13 <i>So the Philistines were subdued, and they came no more into the coast of Israel: and the hand of the LORD was against the Philistines all the days of Samuel.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even unto Gath; and the coasts thereof did Israel deliver out of the hands of the Philistines. And there was peace between Israel and the Amorites.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And he went from year to year in circuit to Bethel, and Gilgal, and Mizpeh, and judged Israel in all those places.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And his return was to Ramah; for there was his house; and there he judged Israel; and there he built an altar unto the LORD.</i></p> | <p>So the Philistines were subdued and did not again enter the territory of Israel. And the hand of the LORD was against the Philistines all the days of Samuel.</p> <p>The cities that the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron to Gath. Israel delivered their territory from the hand of the Philistines. There was also peace between Israel and the Amorites.</p> <p>Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life.</p> <p>He went on a circuit year by year to Bethel, Gilgal, and Mizpah. And he judged Israel in all these places.</p> <p>Then He would return to Ramah, for His home was there, and there also He judged Israel. And He built there an altar to the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Luke 4:8; Deut 13:4; Matt 4:10; Deut 6:13; Isa 55:7
- v4 — Hos 14:8
- v5 — Judg 20:1
- v6 — 2 Sam 14:14; 1 Sam 1:15; Judg 10:10
- v8 — Isa 37:4
- v9 — Jer 15:1; Ps 99:6
- v10 — 1 Sam 2:10
- v12 — 2 Cor 1:10; Josh 4:9; Acts 26:22; Gen 22:14; Gen 35:14

v15 — 1 Sam 7:6

v17 — 1 Sam 1:19

Chapter 8

When Samuel grew old, Israel rejected his corrupt sons as judges and demanded a king like the other nations. Samuel warned them of the ways of a king—conscription, taxation, and servitude—but the people insisted, and the LORD told Samuel to grant their request.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, when Samuel was old, that he made his sons judges over Israel.</i></p> | When Samuel became old, he made his sons judges over Israel. |
| <p>2 <i>Now the name of his firstborn was Joel; and the name of his second, Abiah: they were judges in Beersheba.</i></p> | The name of his firstborn son was Joel, and the name of his second was Abijah. They were judges in Beersheba. |
| <p>3 <i>And his sons walked not in his ways, but turned aside after lucre, and took bribes, and perverted judgment.</i></p> | Yet his sons did not walk in his ways but turned aside after dishonest gain and accepted bribes and perverted justice. |
| <p>4 <i>Then all the elders of Israel gathered themselves together, and came to Samuel unto Ramah,</i></p> | Then all the elders of Israel gathered together and came to Samuel at Ramah |
| <p>5 <i>And said unto him, Behold, thou art old, and thy sons walk not in thy ways: now make us a king to judge us like all the nations.</i></p> | Said to him, "You are old and your sons do not walk in your ways. Now appoint for us a king to judge us like all the nations." |
| <p>6 <i>But the thing displeased Samuel, when they said, Give us a king to judge us. And Samuel prayed unto the LORD.</i></p> | But the thing displeased Samuel when they said, "Give us a king to judge us." And Samuel prayed to the LORD. |
| <p>7 <i>And the LORD said unto Samuel, Hearken unto the voice of the people in all that they say unto thee: for they have not rejected thee, but they have rejected me, that I should not reign over them.</i></p> | The LORD said to Samuel, "Obey the voice of the people in all that they say to you, for they have not rejected you. But they have rejected me from being king over them. |

- 8 *According to all the works which they have done since the day that I brought them up out of Egypt even unto this day, wherewith they have forsaken me, and served other gods, so do they also unto thee.* According to all the deeds that they have done, from the day I brought them up out of Egypt even to this day, forsaking me and serving other gods, so they are also doing to You.
- 9 *Now therefore hearken unto their voice: howbeit yet protest solemnly unto them, and shew them the manner of the king that shall reign over them.* Now then, obey their voice; only you shall solemnly warn them and show them the ways of the king who shall reign over them."
- 10 *And Samuel told all the words of the LORD unto the people that asked of him a king.* So Samuel told all the words of the LORD to the people who were asking for a king from him.
- 11 *And he said, This will be the manner of the king that shall reign over you: He will take your sons, and appoint them for himself, for his chariots, and to be his horsemen; and some shall run before his chariots.* He said, "These will be the ways of the king who will reign over you: he will take your sons and appoint them to his chariots and to be his horsemen and to run before his chariots.
- 12 *And he will appoint him captains over thousands, and captains over fifties; and will set them to ear his ground, and to reap his harvest, and to make his instruments of war, and instruments of his chariots.* He will appoint for himself commanders of thousands and commanders of fifties. Some to plow his ground and to reap his harvest, and to make his implements of war and the equipment of his chariots.
- 13 *And he will take your daughters to be confectionaries, and to be cooks, and to be bakers.* He will take your daughters to be perfumers and cooks and bakers.
- 14 *And he will take your fields, and your vineyards, and your oliveyards, even the best of them, and give them to his servants.* He will take the best of your fields and vineyards and olive orchards and give them to his servants.
- 15 *And he will take the tenth of your seed, and of your vineyards, and give to his officers, and to his servants.* He will take a tenth of your grain and of your vineyards and give it to his officers and to his servants.

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| <p>16 <i>And he will take your menservants, and your maidservants, and your goodliest young men, and your asses, and put them to his work.</i></p> <p>17 <i>He will take the tenth of your sheep: and ye shall be his servants.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And ye shall cry out in that day because of your king which ye shall have chosen you; and the LORD will not hear you in that day.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Nevertheless the people refused to obey the voice of Samuel; and they said, Nay; but we will have a king over us;</i></p> <p>20 <i>That we also may be like all the nations; and that our king may judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Samuel heard all the words of the people, and he rehearsed them in the ears of the LORD.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the LORD said to Samuel, Hearken unto their voice, and make them a king. And Samuel said unto the men of Israel, Go ye every man unto his city.</i></p> | <p>He will take your male servants and female servants and the best of your young men and your donkeys, and put them to his work.</p> <p>He will take a tenth of your flocks, and you shall be his slaves.</p> <p>In that day You will cry out because of Your king, whom You have chosen for yourselves. But the LORD will not answer You in that day."</p> <p>But the people refused to obey the voice of Samuel. And they said, "No! But there shall be a king over us,</p> <p>That we also may be like all the nations, and that our king may judge us and go out before us and fight our battles."</p> <p>When Samuel had heard all the words of the people, he repeated them in the ears of the LORD.</p> <p>The LORD said to Samuel, "Obey their voice and make them a king." Samuel then said to the men of Israel, "Go every man to his city."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 16:18-19; 1 Tim 5:21
v3 — Deut 16:19; Ps 15:5; 1 Tim 6:10; Ex 23:8; Ex 18:21
v5 — Deut 17:14-15

v6 — 1 Sam 15:11

v7 — Luke 10:16; 1 Sam 10:19; Luke 19:14; Luke 19:27; Ex 16:8

v9 — 1 Sam 10:25; 1 Sam 8:11-18

v11 — 1 Sam 14:52; 1 Sam 10:25

v14 — Ezek 46:18; 1 Kgs 21:7

v18 — Mic 3:4; Prov 1:25-28; Isa 1:15

v20 — 1 Sam 8:5

v22 — 1 Sam 8:7

Chapter 9

Saul, a tall and handsome Benjaminite, went searching for his father's lost donkeys and was directed to Samuel the seer. God had already told Samuel that Saul was the one chosen to be king, and Samuel honored Saul at a feast.

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| <p>1 <i>Now there was a man of Benjamin, whose name was Kish, the son of Abiel, the son of Zeror, the son of Bechorath, the son of Aphiah, a Benjamite, a mighty man of power.</i></p> | <p>There was a man of Benjamin whose name was Kish, the son of Abiel, son of Zeror, son of Becorath, son of Aphiah, a Benjaminite, a man of standing.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he had a son, whose name was Saul, a choice young man, and a goodly: and there was not among the children of Israel a goodlier person than he: from his shoulders and upward he was higher than any of the people.</i></p> | <p>He had a son whose name was Saul, a handsome young man. There was not a man among the people of Israel more handsome than he. From his shoulders upward he was taller than any of the people.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Saul** (SAWL) — "asked for" — Son of Kish, of the tribe of Benjamin, Israel's first king. Tall and handsome but ultimately disobedient, he was rejected by God and tormented by an evil spirit. He reigned about forty years before falling on his own sword at the battle of Gilboa.

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| <p>3 <i>And the asses of Kish Saul's father were lost. And Kish said to Saul his son, Take now one of the servants with thee, and arise, go seek the asses.</i></p> | <p>Now the donkeys of Kish, Saul's father, were lost. So Kish said to Saul his son, "Take one of the servants with you, and arise, go and look for the donkeys."</p> |
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- 4 *And he passed through mount Ephraim, and passed through the land of Shalisha, but they found them not: then they passed through the land of Shalim, and there they were not: and he passed through the land of the Benjamites, but they found them not.* They passed through the hill country of Ephraim and through the land of Shalishah. But they did not find them. And they passed through the land of Shaalim. But they were not there. Then they passed through the land of Benjamin. But they did not find them.
- 5 *And when they were come to the land of Zuph, Saul said to his servant that was with him, Come, and let us return; lest my father leave caring for the asses, and take thought for us.* When they came to the land of Zuph, Saul said to his servant who was with him, "Come, let us go back, or my father will stop worrying about the donkeys and worry about us."
- 6 *And he said unto him, Behold now, there is in this city a man of God, and he is an honourable man; all that he saith cometh surely to pass: now let us go thither; peradventure he can shew us our way that we should go.* But he said to him, "See, there is a man of God in this city. He is a man who is held in honor; all that he says comes true. So let us go there. Perhaps He can tell us the way we should go."
- 7 *Then said Saul to his servant, But, behold, if we go, what shall we bring the man? for the bread is spent in our vessels, and there is not a present to bring to the man of God: what have we?* Then Saul said to his servant, "But if we go, what can we bring the man? For the bread in our sacks is gone, and there is no present to bring to the man of God. What do we have?"
- 8 *And the servant answered Saul again, and said, Behold, I have here at hand the fourth part of a shekel of silver: that will I give to the man of God, to tell us our way.* The servant answered Saul again, "Here, I have with me a quarter of a shekel of silver. I will give it to the man of God to tell us our way."
- 9 *(Beforetime in Israel, when a man went to enquire of God, thus he spake, Come, and let us go to the seer: for he that is now called a Prophet was beforetime called a Seer.)* (Formerly in Israel, when a man went to inquire of God, He said, "Come, let us go to the seer," for today's "prophet" was formerly called a "seer.")

- 10 *Then said Saul to his servant, Well said; come, let us go. So they went unto the city where the man of God was.* Then Saul said to his servant, "Well said; come, let us go." So they went to the city where the man of God was.
- 11 *And as they went up the hill to the city, they found young maidens going out to draw water, and said unto them, Is the seer here?* As they went up the hill to the city, they met young women coming out to draw water and said to them, "Is the seer here?"
- 12 *And they answered them, and said, He is; behold, he is before you: make haste now, for he came to day to the city; for there is a sacrifice of the people to day in the high place:* They answered, "He is; see, he is just ahead of you. Hurry. He has come just now to the city, because the people have a sacrifice today on the high place.
- 13 *As soon as ye be come into the city, ye shall straightway find him, before he go up to the high place to eat: for the people will not eat until he come, because he doth bless the sacrifice; and afterwards they eat that be bidden. Now therefore get you up; for about this time ye shall find him.* As soon as you enter the city you will find him, before he goes up to the high place to eat. For the people will not eat until he comes, since he must bless the sacrifice; afterward those who are invited will eat. So go up now, for you will meet him immediately."
- 14 *And they went up into the city: and when they were come into the city, behold, Samuel came out against them, for to go up to the high place.* So they went up to the city. As they were entering the city, Samuel was coming out toward them on his way up to the high place.
- 15 *Now the LORD had told Samuel in his ear a day before Saul came, saying,* Now the day before Saul came, the LORD had revealed to Samuel:
- 16 *To morrow about this time I will send thee a man out of the land of Benjamin, and thou shalt anoint him to be captain over my people Israel, that he may save my people out of the hand of the Philistines: for I have looked upon my people, because their cry is come unto me.* "Tomorrow about this time I will send to You a man from the land of Benjamin, and you shall anoint Him to be prince over my people Israel. He shall save my people from the hand of the Philistines. For I have seen my people, because their cry has come to me."

- 17 *And when Samuel saw Saul, the LORD said unto him, Behold the man whom I spake to thee of! this same shall reign over my people.* When Samuel saw Saul, the LORD told Him, "Here is the man of whom I spoke to you! He it is who shall restrain my people."
- 18 *Then Saul drew near to Samuel in the gate, and said, Tell me, I pray thee, where the seer's house is.* Then Saul approached Samuel in the gate and said, "Tell me where is the house of the seer?"
- 19 *And Samuel answered Saul, and said, I am the seer: go up before me unto the high place; for ye shall eat with me to day, and to morrow I will let thee go, and will tell thee all that is in thine heart.* Samuel answered Saul, "I am the seer. Go up before me to the high place, for today you shall eat with me, and in the morning I will let you go and will tell you all that is on your mind."
- 20 *And as for thine asses that were lost three days ago, set not thy mind on them; for they are found. And on whom is all the desire of Israel? Is it not on thee, and on all thy father's house?* As for your donkeys that were lost three days ago, do not be anxious about them, for they have been found. And for whom is all that is desirable in Israel? Is it not for you and for all your father's house?"
- 21 *And Saul answered and said, Am not I a Benjamite, of the smallest of the tribes of Israel? and my family the least of all the families of the tribe of Benjamin? wherefore then speakest thou so to me?* Saul answered, "Am I not a Benjaminite, from the least of the tribes of Israel? And is not my clan the humblest of all the clans of the tribe of Benjamin? Why then have you spoken to me in this way?"
- 22 *And Samuel took Saul and his servant, and brought them into the parlour, and made them sit in the chiefest place among them that were bidden, which were about thirty persons.* Then Samuel took Saul and his servant and brought them into the hall and gave them a place at the head of those who had been invited, who were about thirty men.
- 23 *And Samuel said unto the cook, Bring the portion which I gave thee, of which I said unto thee, Set it by thee.* Samuel said to the cook, "Bring the portion I gave you, of which I said to you, 'Set it aside.' "

- 24 *And the cook took up the shoulder, and that which was upon it, and set it before Saul. And Samuel said, Behold that which is left! set it before thee, and eat: for unto this time hath it been kept for thee since I said, I have invited the people. So Saul did eat with Samuel that day.* So the cook took up the leg and what was on it and set it before Saul. And Samuel said, "See, what was kept is set before you. Eat, because it was kept for you until the appointed time, since I said, 'I have invited the people.' " So Saul ate with Samuel that day.
- 25 *And when they were come down from the high place into the city, Samuel communed with Saul upon the top of the house.* When they came down from the high place into the city, Samuel communed with Saul upon the top of the house.
- 26 *And they arose early: and it came to pass about the spring of the day, that Samuel called Saul to the top of the house, saying, Up, that I may send thee away. And Saul arose, and they went out both of them, he and Samuel, abroad.* Then at the break of dawn Samuel called to Saul on the roof, "Up, so that I may send you on your way." So Saul arose, and both he and Samuel went out into the street.
- 27 *And as they were going down to the end of the city, Samuel said to Saul, Bid the servant pass on before us, (and he passed on,) but stand thou still a while, that I may shew thee the word of God.* As they were going down to the outskirts of the city, Samuel said to Saul, "Tell the servant to pass on before us"—and he passed on—"but you stand here, that I may make known to you the word of God."

Words in this chapter:

Saul (SAWL) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 14:51; Acts 13:21
v4 — 2 Kgs 4:42
v5 — 1 Sam 10:2
v6 — 1 Kgs 13:1
v7 — 1 Kgs 14:3; 2 Kgs 8:8

v9 — Isa 30:10; 2 Kgs 17:13; 1 Chr 29:29; 1 Chr 26:28; Amos 7:12

v11 — Gen 24:11

v12 — Gen 31:54

v15 — Acts 13:21; 1 Sam 15:1; Ps 25:14; Amos 3:7; Job 33:16

v16 — 1 Sam 10:1; Ps 106:44; Ps 25:18; Ex 3:7-9; 1 Sam 15:1

v20 — 1 Sam 8:5; 1 Sam 12:13

v25 — Deut 22:8; Acts 10:9

Chapter 10

Samuel anointed Saul privately and gave him three signs that were fulfilled that day, including prophesying among the prophets. Saul was then chosen publicly by lot at Mizpah, and Samuel presented him to the people as king.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Samuel took a vial of oil, and poured it upon his head, and kissed him, and said, Is it not because the LORD hath anointed thee to be captain over his inheritance?</i></p> | <p>Then Samuel took a flask of oil and poured it on his head and kissed Him and said, "Has not the LORD anointed You to be prince over His inheritance?"</p> |
| <p>2 <i>When thou art departed from me to day, then thou shalt find two men by Rachel's sepulchre in the border of Benjamin at Zelzah; and they will say unto thee, The asses which thou wentest to seek are found: and, lo, thy father hath left the care of the asses, and sorroweth for you, saying, What shall I do for my son?</i></p> | <p>When you depart from me today, you will meet two men by Rachel's tomb in the territory of Benjamin at Zelzah. They will say to you, "The donkeys that you went to seek are found, and now your father has stopped caring about the donkeys and is anxious about you, saying, "What shall I do about my son?"</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then shalt thou go on forward from thence, and thou shalt come to the plain of Tabor, and there shall meet thee three men going up to God to Bethel, one carrying three kids, and another carrying three loaves of bread, and another carrying a bottle of wine:</i></p> | <p>Then you shall go on from there further and come to the oak of Tabor. Three men going up to God at Bethel will meet you there, one carrying three young goats, another carrying three loaves of bread, and another carrying a skin of wine.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And they will salute thee, and give thee two loaves of bread; which thou shalt receive of their hands.</i></p> | <p>They will greet you and give you two loaves of bread, which you shall accept from their hand.</p> |

- 5 *After that thou shalt come to the hill of God, where is the garrison of the Philistines: and it shall come to pass, when thou art come thither to the city, that thou shalt meet a company of prophets coming down from the high place with a psaltery, and a tabret, and a pipe, and a harp, before them; and they shall prophesy:* After that you shall come to Gibeath-elohim, where there is a garrison of the Philistines. And there, as soon as you come to the city, you will meet a group of prophets coming down from the high place with harp, tambourine, flute, and lyre before them, prophesying.
- 6 *And the Spirit of the LORD will come upon thee, and thou shalt prophesy with them, and shalt be turned into another man.* Then the Spirit of the LORD will rush upon You, and You will prophesy with them and be turned into a different man.
- 7 *And let it be, when these signs are come unto thee, that thou do as occasion serve thee; for God is with thee.* Now when these signs meet You, do what Your hand finds to do, for God is with You.
- 8 *And thou shalt go down before me to Gilgal; and, behold, I will come down unto thee, to offer burnt offerings, and to sacrifice sacrifices of peace offerings: seven days shalt thou tarry, till I come to thee, and shew thee what thou shalt do.* Then go down before me to Gilgal. And I am coming down to You to offer burnt offerings and to sacrifice peace offerings. Seven days You shall wait, until I come to You and show You what You shall do."
- 9 *And it was so, that when he had turned his back to go from Samuel, God gave him another heart: and all those signs came to pass that day.* When he turned his back to leave Samuel, God gave him another heart. And all these signs came to pass that day.
- 10 *And when they came thither to the hill, behold, a company of prophets met him; and the Spirit of God came upon him, and he prophesied among them.* When they came to Gibeah, a group of prophets met Him, and the Spirit of God rushed upon Him. He prophesied among them.

- 11 *And it came to pass, when all that knew him beforetime saw that, behold, he prophesied among the prophets, then the people said one to another, What is this that is come unto the son of Kish? Is Saul also among the prophets?* When all who knew him previously saw how he prophesied with the prophets, the people said to one another, "What has come over the son of Kish? Is Saul also among the prophets?"
- 12 *And one of the same place answered and said, But who is their father? Therefore it became a proverb, Is Saul also among the prophets?* A man of the place answered, "And who is their father?" Therefore it became a proverb, "Is Saul also among the prophets?"
- 13 *And when he had made an end of prophesying, he came to the high place.* When he finished prophesying, he came to the high place.
- 14 *And Saul's uncle said unto him and to his servant, Whither went ye? And he said, To seek the asses: and when we saw that they were no where, we came to Samuel.* Saul's uncle said to him and to his servant, "Where did you go?" And he said, "To seek the donkeys. And when we saw they were not to be found, we went to Samuel."
- 15 *And Saul's uncle said, Tell me, I pray thee, what Samuel said unto you.* Saul's uncle said, "Please tell me what Samuel said to you."
- 16 *And Saul said unto his uncle, He told us plainly that the asses were found. But of the matter of the kingdom, whereof Samuel spake, he told him not.* Saul said to his uncle, "He told us plainly that the donkeys had been found." But about the matter of the kingdom, of which Samuel had spoken, he did not tell him anything.
- 17 *And Samuel called the people together unto the LORD to Mizpeh;* Now Samuel called the people together to the LORD at Mizpah.
- 18 *And said unto the children of Israel, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I brought up Israel out of Egypt, and delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all kingdoms, and of them that oppressed you:* He said to the people of Israel, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, 'I brought up Israel out of Egypt. I delivered You from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all the kingdoms that were oppressing You.'"

- 19 *And ye have this day rejected your God, who himself saved you out of all your adversities and your tribulations; and ye have said unto him, Nay, but set a king over us. Now therefore present yourselves before the LORD by your tribes, and by your thousands.* But today You have rejected Your God, Who saves You from all Your calamities and Your distresses, and You have said to Him, 'No, but set a king over us.' Now therefore present yourselves before the LORD by Your tribes and by Your thousands."
- 20 *And when Samuel had caused all the tribes of Israel to come near, the tribe of Benjamin was taken.* Then Samuel brought all the tribes of Israel near, and the tribe of Benjamin was taken by lot.
- 21 *When he had caused the tribe of Benjamin to come near by their families, the family of Matri was taken, and Saul the son of Kish was taken: and when they sought him, he could not be found.* He brought the tribe of Benjamin near by its clans, and the clan of the Matrites was taken by lot. Saul the son of Kish was taken by lot. But when they sought him, he could not be found.
- 22 *Therefore they enquired of the LORD further, if the man should yet come thither. And the LORD answered, Behold, he hath hid himself among the stuff.* So they inquired again of the LORD, "Is there a man still to come?" And the LORD said, "See, He has hidden Himself among the baggage."
- 23 *And they ran and fetched him thence: and when he stood among the people, he was higher than any of the people from his shoulders and upward.* Then they ran and took Him from there. And when He stood among the people, he was taller than any of the people from his shoulders upward.
- 24 *And Samuel said to all the people, See ye him whom the LORD hath chosen, that there is none like him among all the people? And all the people shouted, and said, God save the king.* Samuel said to all the people, "Do you see him whom the LORD has chosen? There is none like Him among all the people." And all the people shouted, "Long live the king!"

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| <p>25 <i>Then Samuel told the people the manner of the kingdom, and wrote it in a book, and laid it up before the LORD. And Samuel sent all the people away, every man to his house.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And Saul also went home to Gibeah; and there went with him a band of men, whose hearts God had touched.</i></p> <p>27 <i>But the children of Belial said, How shall this man save us? And they despised him, and brought him no presents. But he held his peace.</i></p> | <p>Then Samuel told the people the rights and duties of the kingship. He wrote them in a book and laid it up before the LORD. Then Samuel sent all the people away, each one to his home.</p> <p>Saul also went to his home at Gibeah, and with him went men of valor whose hearts God had touched.</p> <p>But some worthless fellows said, "How can this man save us?" And they despised him and brought him no present. But he held his peace.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Elohim (*el-oh-HEEM*) — Hebrew plural word for God — used throughout Genesis; the plural form expresses majesty, not multiple gods.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Rachel (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 16:13; Ps 78:71; 1 Sam 9:16; Ps 2:12; Acts 13:21
- v5 — 2 Kgs 3:15; 1 Sam 13:3; 1 Sam 19:20
- v6 — 1 Sam 10:10; 1 Sam 19:23-24; Num 11:25; Judg 14:6; 1 Sam 16:13
- v7 — Judg 6:12; Josh 1:5
- v8 — 1 Sam 11:14-15; 1 Sam 13:4
- v11 — 1 Sam 19:24; John 7:15
- v18 — Judg 6:8-9
- v19 — 1 Sam 12:12
- v23 — 1 Sam 9:2
- v24 — 1 Kgs 1:25; 1 Kgs 1:39; 2 Sam 21:6
- v25 — 1 Sam 8:11-18; Deut 17:14-20
- v27 — Deut 13:13; 1 Sam 2:12; 1 Kgs 10:25; 2 Chr 17:5; Acts 7:35

Chapter 11

Nahash the Ammonite besieged Jabesh-gilead and demanded that every man's right eye be gouged out. Saul rallied all Israel, defeated the Ammonites at the battle of Jabesh-gilead, and the kingdom was renewed at Gilgal.

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| 1 | <i>Then Nahash the Ammonite came up, and encamped against Jabeshgilead: and all the men of Jabesh said unto Nahash, Make a covenant with us, and we will serve thee.</i> | Then Nahash the Ammonite came up and besieged Jabesh-gilead. All the men of Jabesh said to Nahash, "Make a treaty with us. We will serve you." |
| 2 | <i>And Nahash the Ammonite answered them, On this condition will I make a covenant with you, that I may thrust out all your right eyes, and lay it for a reproach upon all Israel.</i> | But Nahash the Ammonite said to them, "On this condition I will make a treaty with you, that I gouge out all your right eyes, and so bring disgrace on all Israel." |
| 3 | <i>And the elders of Jabesh said unto him, Give us seven days' respite, that we may send messengers unto all the coasts of Israel: and then, if there be no man to save us, we will come out to thee.</i> | The elders of Jabesh said to him, "Give us seven days' respite that we may send messengers through all the territory of Israel. Then, if there is no one to save us, we will give ourselves up to you." |
| 4 | <i>Then came the messengers to Gibeah of Saul, and told the tidings in the ears of the people: and all the people lifted up their voices, and wept.</i> | When the messengers came to Gibeah of Saul, they reported the news in the ears of the people. All the people wept aloud. |
| 5 | <i>And, behold, Saul came after the herd out of the field; and Saul said, What aileth the people that they weep? And they told him the tidings of the men of Jabesh.</i> | Now Saul was coming from the field behind the oxen, and Saul said, "What is wrong with the people, that they are weeping?" So they told him the news of the men of Jabesh. |
| 6 | <i>And the Spirit of God came upon Saul when he heard those tidings, and his anger was kindled greatly.</i> | The Spirit of God rushed upon Saul when he heard these words. His anger was greatly kindled. |

- 7 *And he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them throughout all the coasts of Israel by the hands of messengers, saying, Whosoever cometh not forth after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done unto his oxen. And the fear of the LORD fell on the people, and they came out with one consent.* He took a yoke of oxen and cut them in pieces and sent them throughout all the territory of Israel by the hand of messengers, saying, "Whoever does not come out after Saul and Samuel, so shall it be done to his oxen!" Then the dread of the LORD fell upon the people. They came out as one man.
- 8 *And when he numbered them in Bezek, the children of Israel were three hundred thousand, and the men of Judah thirty thousand.* When He mustered them at Bezek, the people of Israel were three hundred thousand, and the men of Judah thirty thousand.
- 9 *And they said unto the messengers that came, Thus shall ye say unto the men of Jabeshgilead, To morrow, by that time the sun be hot, ye shall have help. And the messengers came and shewed it to the men of Jabesh; and they were glad.* They said to the messengers who had come, "Thus shall You say to the men of Jabesh-gilead: 'Tomorrow, by the time the sun is hot, You shall have deliverance.' " When the messengers came and told the men of Jabesh, they were glad.
- 10 *Therefore the men of Jabesh said, To morrow we will come out unto you, and ye shall do with us all that seemeth good unto you.* Therefore the men of Jabesh said, "Tomorrow we will give ourselves up to You, and You may do to us whatever seems good to You."
- 11 *And it was so on the morrow, that Saul put the people in three companies; and they came into the midst of the host in the morning watch, and slew the Ammonites until the heat of the day: and it came to pass, that they which remained were scattered, so that two of them were not left together.* The next day Saul put the people in three companies. And they came into the midst of the camp in the morning watch and struck down the Ammonites until the heat of the day. And those who survived were scattered, so that no two of them were left together.

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| <p>12 <i>And the people said unto Samuel, Who is he that said, Shall Saul reign over us? bring the men, that we may put them to death.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And Saul said, There shall not a man be put to death this day: for to day the LORD hath wrought salvation in Israel.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then said Samuel to the people, Come, and let us go to Gilgal, and renew the kingdom there.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And all the people went to Gilgal; and there they made Saul king before the LORD in Gilgal; and there they sacrificed sacrifices of peace offerings before the LORD; and there Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced greatly.</i></p> | <p>Then the people said to Samuel, "Who is it that said, 'Shall Saul reign over us?' Bring the men, that we may put them to death."</p> <p>But Saul said, "Not a man shall be put to death this day, for today the LORD has worked salvation in Israel."</p> <p>Then Samuel said to the people, "Come, let us go to Gilgal and there renew the kingdom."</p> <p>So all the people went to Gilgal, and there they made Saul king before the LORD in Gilgal. There they sacrificed peace offerings before the LORD, and there Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced greatly.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Sam 12:12; Ezek 17:13; 1 Kgs 20:34; Gen 26:28; Judg 21:8

v2 — 1 Sam 17:26

v4 — Judg 2:4; 1 Sam 10:26

v6 — 1 Sam 10:10; Judg 6:34; 1 Sam 16:13

v7 — Judg 19:29

v9 — Ps 18:17

v12 — 1 Sam 10:27; Luke 19:27

v13 — Ex 14:13; 1 Sam 19:5; 2 Sam 19:22

v15 — 1 Sam 10:8; 1 Sam 10:17

Chapter 12

Samuel gave his farewell address, reminding Israel of God's faithfulness and warning that both they and their king must follow the LORD. He called down thunder and rain in the wheat harvest as a sign, and the people acknowledged their sin in asking for a king.

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| 1 <i>And Samuel said unto all Israel, Behold, I have hearkened unto your voice in all that ye said unto me, and have made a king over you.</i> | Samuel said to all Israel, "See, I have obeyed your voice in all that you have said to me and have made a king over you. |
| 2 <i>And now, behold, the king walketh before you: and I am old and grayheaded; and, behold, my sons are with you: and I have walked before you from my childhood unto this day.</i> | Now, see, the king walks before you. I am old and gray. See, my sons are with you. I have walked before you from my youth until this day. |
| 3 <i>Behold, here I am: witness against me before the LORD, and before his anointed: whose ox have I taken? or whose ass have I taken? or whom have I defrauded? whom have I oppressed? or of whose hand have I received any bribe to blind mine eyes therewith? and I will restore it you.</i> | Here I am; testify against me before the LORD and before His anointed. Whose ox have I taken? Or whose donkey have I taken? Or whom have I defrauded? Whom have I oppressed? Or from whose hand have I taken a bribe to blind my eyes with it? Testify against me and I will restore it to You." |
| 4 <i>And they said, Thou hast not defrauded us, nor oppressed us, neither hast thou taken ought of any man's hand.</i> | They said, "You have not defrauded us or oppressed us or taken anything from any man's hand." |
| 5 <i>And he said unto them, The LORD is witness against you, and his anointed is witness this day, that ye have not found ought in my hand. And they answered, He is witness.</i> | He said to them, "The LORD is witness against You. His anointed is witness this day, that You have not found anything in my hand." And they said, "He is witness." |
| 6 <i>And Samuel said unto the people, It is the LORD that advanced Moses and Aaron, and that brought your fathers up out of the land of Egypt.</i> | Samuel said to the people, "The LORD is witness, who appointed Moses and Aaron and brought your fathers up out of the land of Egypt. |

- 7 *Now therefore stand still, that I may reason with you before the LORD of all the righteous acts of the LORD, which he did to you and to your fathers.* Now therefore stand still that I may plead with You before the LORD concerning all the righteous deeds of the LORD that He performed for You and for Your fathers.
- 8 *When Jacob was come into Egypt, and your fathers cried unto the LORD, then the LORD sent Moses and Aaron, which brought forth your fathers out of Egypt, and made them dwell in this place.* When Jacob went into Egypt, and the Egyptians oppressed them, then Your fathers cried out to the LORD and the LORD sent Moses and Aaron, who brought your fathers out of Egypt and made them dwell in this place.
- 9 *And when they forgat the LORD their God, he sold them into the hand of Sisera, captain of the host of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab, and they fought against them.* But they forgot the LORD their God. And He sold them into the hand of Sisera, commander of the army of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab. And they fought against them.
- 10 *And they cried unto the LORD, and said, We have sinned, because we have forsaken the LORD, and have served Baalim and Ashtaroth: but now deliver us out of the hand of our enemies, and we will serve thee.* Then they cried out to the LORD and said, 'We have sinned, because we have forsaken the LORD and have served the Baals and the Ashtaroth. But now deliver us out of the hand of our enemies. We will serve You.'
- 11 *And the LORD sent Jerubbaal, and Bedan, and Jephthah, and Samuel, and delivered you out of the hand of your enemies on every side, and ye dwelled safe.* The LORD sent Jerubbaal and Bedan and Jephthah and Samuel and delivered you from the hand of your enemies on every side, and You lived in safety.
- 12 *And when ye saw that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon came against you, ye said unto me, Nay; but a king shall reign over us: when the LORD your God was your king.* When You saw that Nahash the king of the Ammonites came against you, you said to me, 'No, but a king shall reign over us,' when the LORD Your God was Your king.

- 13 *Now therefore behold the king whom ye have chosen, and whom ye have desired! and, behold, the LORD hath set a king over you.* Now see the king whom you have chosen, for whom you have asked. See, the LORD has set a king over You.
- 14 *If ye will fear the LORD, and serve him, and obey his voice, and not rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then shall both ye and also the king that reigneth over you continue following the LORD your God:* If You will fear the LORD and serve Him and obey His voice and not rebel against the commandment of the LORD, and if both You and the king who reigns over you will follow the LORD Your God, it will be well.
- 15 *But if ye will not obey the voice of the LORD, but rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then shall the hand of the LORD be against you, as it was against your fathers.* But if You will not obey the voice of the LORD, but rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then the hand of the LORD will be against You and Your king.
- 16 *Now therefore stand and see this great thing, which the LORD will do before your eyes.* Now therefore stand still and see this great thing that the LORD will do before Your eyes.
- 17 *Is it not wheat harvest to day? I will call unto the LORD, and he shall send thunder and rain; that ye may perceive and see that your wickedness is great, which ye have done in the sight of the LORD, in asking you a king.* Is it not wheat harvest today? I will call upon the LORD. He will send thunder and rain. And You shall know and see that Your wickedness is great, which You have done in the sight of the LORD, in asking for yourselves a king."
- 18 *So Samuel called unto the LORD; and the LORD sent thunder and rain that day: and all the people greatly feared the LORD and Samuel.* So Samuel called upon the LORD. The LORD sent thunder and rain that day. All the people greatly feared the LORD and Samuel.
- 19 *And all the people said unto Samuel, Pray for thy servants unto the LORD thy God, that we die not: for we have added unto all our sins this evil, to ask us a king.* All the people said to Samuel, "Pray for your servants to the LORD your God, that we may not die, for we have added to all our sins this evil, to ask for ourselves a king."

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| <p>20 <i>And Samuel said unto the people, Fear not: ye have done all this wickedness: yet turn not aside from following the LORD, but serve the LORD with all your heart;</i></p> <p>21 <i>And turn ye not aside: for then should ye go after vain things, which cannot profit nor deliver; for they are vain.</i></p> <p>22 <i>For the LORD will not forsake his people for his great name's sake: because it hath pleased the LORD to make you his people.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Moreover as for me, God forbid that I should sin against the LORD in ceasing to pray for you: but I will teach you the good and the right way:</i></p> <p>24 <i>Only fear the LORD, and serve him in truth with all your heart: for consider how great things he hath done for you.</i></p> <p>25 <i>But if ye shall still do wickedly, ye shall be consumed, both ye and your king.</i></p> | <p>Samuel said to the people, "Do not be afraid; you have done all this evil. Yet do not turn aside from following the LORD, but serve the LORD with all your heart.</p> <p>Do not turn aside after empty things that cannot profit or deliver, for they are empty.</p> <p>For the LORD will not forsake His people, for His great name's sake, because it has pleased the LORD to make You a people for Himself.</p> <p>Moreover, as for me, far be it from me that I should sin against the LORD by ceasing to pray for You. I will instruct You in the good and the right way.</p> <p>Only fear the LORD and serve Him faithfully with all Your heart. For consider what great things He has done for You.</p> <p>But if You still do wickedly, You shall be swept away, both You and Your king."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v3 — Acts 20:33; Num 16:15; 1 Pet 5:2; 1 Sam 24:6; Deut 16:19

- v9 — Judg 13:1; Judg 3:12; Judg 4:2; Judg 10:7
- v10 — Judg 10:10; Judg 2:13
- v11 — Judg 6:32; Judg 4:6
- v14 — Josh 24:14; Deut 28:1-14
- v15 — Josh 24:20; Isa 1:20
- v16 — Ex 14:13; Ex 14:31
- v17 — 1 Sam 8:7; Prov 26:1; 1 Sam 7:9-10
- v21 — Hab 2:18; Jer 16:19; Jer 10:15
- v22 — Deut 14:2; Ps 106:8; Deut 7:7-8; Phil 1:6; 1 Kgs 6:13
- v23 — Col 1:9; Rom 1:9; 2 Tim 1:3; 1 Thess 3:10; 1 Kgs 8:36
- v24 — Deut 10:21; Prov 1:7; Heb 12:29; Ps 126:2-3; Isa 5:12

Chapter 13

Saul's son Jonathan attacked the Philistine garrison at Geba, provoking a massive Philistine response. When Samuel delayed coming to Gilgal, Saul unlawfully offered the burnt offering himself; Samuel told him his kingdom would not continue and that God had sought a man after His own heart.

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| 1 | <i>Saul reigned one year; and when he had reigned two years over Israel,</i> | Saul reigned one year; and when he had reigned two years over Israel, |
| 2 | <i>Saul chose him three thousand men of Israel; whereof two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in mount Bethel, and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin; and the rest of the people he sent every man to his tent.</i> | Saul chose three thousand men of Israel. Two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and the hill country of Bethel, and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin. The rest of the people he sent home, every man to his tent. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jonathan** (JON-ah-than) — "the LORD has given" — Saul's eldest son and heir to the throne, yet David's most devoted friend. He made a covenant of loyalty with David and protected him from Saul's murderous jealousy. He died alongside his father at the battle of Gilboa.

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| 3 | <i>And Jonathan smote the garrison of the Philistines that was in Geba, and the Philistines heard of it. And Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, Let the Hebrews hear.</i> | Jonathan defeated the garrison of the Philistines that was at Geba, and the Philistines heard of it. And Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, "Let the Hebrews hear." |
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- 4 *And all Israel heard say that Saul had smitten a garrison of the Philistines, and that Israel also was had in abomination with the Philistines. And the people were called together after Saul to Gilgal.* All Israel heard it said that Saul had defeated the garrison of the Philistines, and also that Israel had become a stench to the Philistines. And the people were called out to join Saul at Gilgal.
- 5 *And the Philistines gathered themselves together to fight with Israel, thirty thousand chariots, and six thousand horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the sea shore in multitude: and they came up, and pitched in Michmash, eastward from Bethaven.* The Philistines mustered to fight with Israel, thirty thousand chariots and six thousand horsemen and troops like the sand on the seashore in multitude. They came up and encamped in Michmash, to the east of Beth-aven.
- 6 *When the men of Israel saw that they were in a strait, (for the people were distressed,) then the people did hide themselves in caves, and in thickets, and in rocks, and in high places, and in pits.* When the men of Israel saw that they were in trouble (for the people were hard pressed), the people hid themselves in caves and in thickets and in rocks and in high places and in pits.
- 7 *And some of the Hebrews went over Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead. As for Saul, he was yet in Gilgal, and all the people followed him trembling.* Some Hebrews crossed the fords of the Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead. Saul was still at Gilgal. All the people followed him trembling.
- 8 *And he tarried seven days, according to the set time that Samuel had appointed: but Samuel came not to Gilgal; and the people were scattered from him.* He waited seven days, the time appointed by Samuel. But Samuel did not come to Gilgal, and the people were scattering from him.
- 9 *And Saul said, Bring hither a burnt offering to me, and peace offerings. And he offered the burnt offering.* So Saul said, "Bring the burnt offering here to me, and the peace offerings." And he offered the burnt offering.

- 10 *And it came to pass, that as soon as he had made an end of offering the burnt offering, behold, Samuel came; and Saul went out to meet him, that he might salute him.* As soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, Samuel arrived. And Saul went out to meet him and greet him.
- 11 *And Samuel said, What hast thou done? And Saul said, Because I saw that the people were scattered from me, and that thou camest not within the days appointed, and that the Philistines gathered themselves together at Michmash;* Samuel said, "What have you done?" And Saul said, "When I saw that the people were scattering from me, and that you did not come within the days appointed, and that the Philistines had mustered at Michmash,
- 12 *Therefore said I, The Philistines will come down now upon me to Gilgal, and I have not made supplication unto the LORD: I forced myself therefore, and offered a burnt offering.* I said, 'Now the Philistines will come down against me at Gilgal. I have not sought the favor of the LORD.' So I forced myself and offered the burnt offering."
- 13 *And Samuel said to Saul, Thou hast done foolishly: thou hast not kept the commandment of the LORD thy God, which he commanded thee: for now would the LORD have established thy kingdom upon Israel for ever.* Samuel said to Saul, "You have done foolishly. You have not kept the command of the LORD your God, with which He commanded you. For then the LORD would have established Your kingdom over Israel forever.
- 14 *But now thy kingdom shall not continue: the LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart, and the LORD hath commanded him to be captain over his people, because thou hast not kept that which the LORD commanded thee.* But now Your kingdom shall not continue. The LORD has sought out a man after his own heart. The LORD has commanded Him to be prince over His people, because You have not kept what the LORD commanded You."

- 15 *And Samuel arose, and gat him up from Gilgal unto Gibeah of Benjamin. And Saul numbered the people that were present with him, about six hundred men.* Samuel arose and went up from Gilgal. The rest of the people went up after Saul to meet the army; they went up from Gilgal to Gibeah of Benjamin. And Saul numbered the people who were present with him, about six hundred men.
- 16 *And Saul, and Jonathan his son, and the people that were present with them, abode in Gibeah of Benjamin: but the Philistines encamped in Michmash.* Saul and Jonathan his son and the people who were present with them stayed in Geba of Benjamin, but the Philistines encamped at Michmash.
- 17 *And the spoilers came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies: one company turned unto the way that leadeth to Ophrah, unto the land of Shual:* Raiders came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies. One company turned toward Ophrah, to the land of Shual.
- 18 *And another company turned the way to Bethhoron: and another company turned to the way of the border that looketh to the valley of Zeboim toward the wilderness.* Another company turned toward Beth-horon. And another company turned toward the border that looks down on the Valley of Zeboim toward the wilderness.
- 19 *Now there was no smith found throughout all the land of Israel: for the Philistines said, Lest the Hebrews make them swords or spears:* Now there was no blacksmith to be found throughout all the land of Israel, for the Philistines said, "Lest the Hebrews make themselves swords or spears."
- 20 *But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his coulter, and his axe, and his mattock.* But every one of the Israelites went down to the Philistines to sharpen his plowshare, his mattock, his axe, or his sickle,

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| <p>21 <i>Yet they had a file for the mattocks, and for the coulter, and for the forks, and for the axes, and to sharpen the goads.</i></p> <p>22 <i>So it came to pass in the day of battle, that there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people that were with Saul and Jonathan: but with Saul and with Jonathan his son was there found.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And the garrison of the Philistines went out to the passage of Michmash.</i></p> | <p>The charge was two-thirds of a shekel for the plowshares and for the mattocks, and a third of a shekel for sharpening the axes and for setting the goads.</p> <p>So on the day of the battle there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people with Saul and Jonathan, but Saul and Jonathan his son had them.</p> <p>The garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Sam 10:26
- v3 — 1 Sam 10:5
- v5 — 1 Sam 14:23; Josh 11:4
- v6 — Judg 6:2
- v8 — 1 Sam 10:8
- v9 — 1 Kgs 3:4
- v10 — 1 Sam 15:13
- v13 — 1 Sam 15:22; 2 Chr 16:9; 1 Sam 15:28; 1 Sam 15:11
- v14 — Acts 13:22; 1 Sam 15:28; Ps 89:19-37; Ps 78:70; 1 Sam 16:1
- v15 — 1 Sam 14:2; 1 Sam 13:2
- v18 — Neh 11:34
- v19 — 2 Kgs 24:14

Chapter 14

Jonathan and his armor-bearer attacked a Philistine outpost, and the LORD threw the enemy into a panic, winning the battle of Michmash. Saul's rash oath that no one should eat nearly resulted in Jonathan's death, but the people rescued him.

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| 1 | <i>Now it came to pass upon a day, that Jonathan the son of Saul said unto the young man that bare his armour, Come, and let us go over to the Philistines' garrison, that is on the other side. But he told not his father.</i> | One day Jonathan the son of Saul said to the young man who carried his armor, "Come, let us go over to the Philistine garrison on the other side." But he did not tell his father. |
| 2 | <i>And Saul tarried in the uttermost part of Gibeah under a pomegranate tree which is in Migron: and the people that were with him were about six hundred men;</i> | Saul was staying in the outskirts of Gibeah in the pomegranate cave at Migron. The people who were with him were about six hundred men, |
| 3 | <i>And Ahiah, the son of Ahitub, Ichabod's brother, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli, the LORD'S priest in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. And the people knew not that Jonathan was gone.</i> | Including Ahijah the son of Ahitub, Ichabod's brother, son of Phinehas, son of Eli, the priest of the LORD in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. And the people did not know that Jonathan had gone. |
| 4 | <i>And between the passages, by which Jonathan sought to go over unto the Philistines' garrison, there was a sharp rock on the one side, and a sharp rock on the other side: and the name of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh.</i> | Within the passes, by which Jonathan sought to go over to the Philistine garrison, there was a rocky crag on the one side and a rocky crag on the other side. The name of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh. |
| 5 | <i>The forefront of the one was situate northward over against Michmash, and the other southward over against Gibeah.</i> | The one crag rose on the north in front of Michmash, and the other on the south in front of Geba. |

- 6 *And Jonathan said to the young man that bare his armour, Come, and let us go over unto the garrison of these uncircumcised: it may be that the LORD will work for us: for there is no restraint to the LORD to save by many or by few.* Jonathan said to the young man who carried his armor, "Come, let us go over to the garrison of these uncircumcised. It may be that the LORD will work for us, for nothing can hinder the LORD from saving by many or by few."
- 7 *And his armourbearer said unto him, Do all that is in thine heart: turn thee; behold, I am with thee according to thy heart.* his armor-bearer said to Him, "Do all that is in Your heart. Do as You wish. See, I am with You heart and soul."
- 8 *Then said Jonathan, Behold, we will pass over unto these men, and we will discover ourselves unto them.* Then Jonathan said, "See, we will cross over to the men. We will show ourselves to them."
- 9 *If they say thus unto us, Tarry until we come to you; then we will stand still in our place, and will not go up unto them.* If they say to us, 'Wait until we come to you,' then we will stand still in our place. We will not go up to them."
- 10 *But if they say thus, Come up unto us; then we will go up: for the LORD hath delivered them into our hand: and this shall be a sign unto us.* But if they say, 'Come up to us,' then we will go up, for the LORD has given them into our hand. And this shall be the sign to us."
- 11 *And both of them discovered themselves unto the garrison of the Philistines: and the Philistines said, Behold, the Hebrews come forth out of the holes where they had hid themselves.* So both of them showed themselves to the garrison of the Philistines. And the Philistines said, "Look, Hebrews are coming out of the holes where they have hidden themselves."
- 12 *And the men of the garrison answered Jonathan and his armourbearer, and said, Come up to us, and we will shew you a thing. And Jonathan said unto his armourbearer, Come up after me: for the LORD hath delivered them into the hand of Israel.* The men of the garrison hailed Jonathan and his armor-bearer and said, "Come up to us. We will show You something." And Jonathan said to his armor-bearer, "Come up after me, for the LORD has given them into the hand of Israel."

- 13 *And Jonathan climbed up upon his hands and upon his feet, and his armourbearer after him: and they fell before Jonathan; and his armourbearer slew after him.* Then Jonathan climbed up on his hands and feet. his armor-bearer after him. And they fell before Jonathan. his armor-bearer killed them after him.
- 14 *And that first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armourbearer made, was about twenty men, within as it were an half acre of land, which a yoke of oxen might plow.* That first strike, which Jonathan and his armor-bearer made, killed about twenty men within about half a furrow's length in an acre of land.
- 15 *And there was trembling in the host, in the field, and among all the people: the garrison, and the spoilers, they also trembled, and the earth quaked: so it was a very great trembling.* There was a panic in the camp, in the field, and among all the people. The garrison and even the raiders trembled, the earth quaked. It became a very great panic.
- 16 *And the watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked; and, behold, the multitude melted away, and they went on beating down one another.* The watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked, and there was the crowd, scattered and going in all directions.
- 17 *Then said Saul unto the people that were with him, Number now, and see who is gone from us. And when they had numbered, behold, Jonathan and his armourbearer were not there.* Then Saul said to the people who were with him, "Count and see who has gone from us." And when they had counted, Jonathan and his armor-bearer were not there.
- 18 *And Saul said unto Ahiah, Bring hither the ark of God. For the ark of God was at that time with the children of Israel.* Saul said to Ahijah, "Bring the ark of God here." For the ark of God was with the people of Israel at that time.
- 19 *And it came to pass, while Saul talked unto the priest, that the noise that was in the host of the Philistines went on and increased: and Saul said unto the priest, Withdraw thine hand.* While Saul was talking to the priest, the tumult in the camp of the Philistines increased more and more. So Saul said to the priest, "Withdraw your hand."

- 20 *And Saul and all the people that were with him assembled themselves, and they came to the battle: and, behold, every man's sword was against his fellow, and there was a very great discomfiture.* Then Saul and all the people who were with him rallied and went into the battle. And every man's sword was against his fellow, and there was very great confusion.
- 21 *Moreover the Hebrews that were with the Philistines before that time, which went up with them into the camp from the country round about, even they also turned to be with the Israelites that were with Saul and Jonathan.* Now the Hebrews who had been with the Philistines before that time and had gone up with them into the camp turned to be with the Israelites who were with Saul and Jonathan.
- 22 *Likewise all the men of Israel which had hid themselves in mount Ephraim, when they heard that the Philistines fled, even they also followed hard after them in the battle.* Likewise, when all the men of Israel who had hidden themselves in the hill country of Ephraim heard that the Philistines were fleeing, they too followed hard after them in the battle.
- 23 *So the LORD saved Israel that day: and the battle passed over unto Bethaven.* So the LORD saved Israel that day. And the battle passed beyond Beth-aven.
- 24 *And the men of Israel were distressed that day: for Saul had adjured the people, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food until evening, that I may be avenged on mine enemies. So none of the people tasted any food.* The men of Israel had been hard pressed that day, so Saul had laid an oath on the people, saying, "Cursed be the man who eats food until it is evening and I am avenged on my enemies." So none of the people had tasted food.
- 25 *And all they of the land came to a wood; and there was honey upon the ground.* Now when all the people came to the forest, there was honey on the ground.
- 26 *And when the people were come into the wood, behold, the honey dropped; but no man put his hand to his mouth: for the people feared the oath.* When the people entered the forest, the honey was dripping, but no one put his hand to his mouth, for the people feared the oath.

- 27 *But Jonathan heard not when his father charged the people with the oath: wherefore he put forth the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in an honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes were enlightened.* But Jonathan had not heard his father charge the people with the oath, so he put out the tip of the staff that was in his hand and dipped it in the honeycomb and put his hand to his mouth. His eyes brightened.
- 28 *Then answered one of the people, and said, Thy father straitly charged the people with an oath, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food this day. And the people were faint.* Then one of the people said, "Your father strictly charged the people with an oath, saying, 'Cursed be the man who eats food this day.' " And the people were faint.
- 29 *Then said Jonathan, My father hath troubled the land: see, I pray you, how mine eyes have been enlightened, because I tasted a little of this honey.* Then Jonathan said, "My father has troubled the land. See how my eyes have brightened because I tasted a little of this honey.
- 30 *How much more, if haply the people had eaten freely to day of the spoil of their enemies which they found? for had there not been now a much greater slaughter among the Philistines?* How much better if the people had eaten freely today of the spoil of their enemies that they found. For now the slaughter among the Philistines has not been great."
- 31 *And they smote the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon: and the people were very faint.* They struck down the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon. And the people were very faint.
- 32 *And the people flew upon the spoil, and took sheep, and oxen, and calves, and slew them on the ground: and the people did eat them with the blood.* The people pounced on the spoil and took sheep and oxen and calves and slaughtered them on the ground. And the people ate them with the blood.
- 33 *Then they told Saul, saying, Behold, the people sin against the LORD, in that they eat with the blood. And he said, Ye have transgressed: roll a great stone unto me this day.* Then they told Saul, "See, the people are sinning against the LORD by eating with the blood." And He said, "You have dealt treacherously. Roll a large stone to me here today."

- 34 *And Saul said, Disperse yourselves among the people, and say unto them, Bring me hither every man his ox, and every man his sheep, and slay them here, and eat; and sin not against the LORD in eating with the blood. And all the people brought every man his ox with him that night, and slew them there.* Saul said, "Scatter among the people and say to them, 'Let every man bring his ox or his sheep and slaughter it here and eat, and do not sin against the LORD by eating with the blood.' " So every one of the people brought his ox with him that night and slaughtered it there.
- 35 *And Saul built an altar unto the LORD: the same was the first altar that he built unto the LORD.* Saul built an altar to the LORD; it was the first altar that He built to the LORD.
- 36 *And Saul said, Let us go down after the Philistines by night, and spoil them until the morning light, and let us not leave a man of them. And they said, Do whatsoever seemeth good unto thee. Then said the priest, Let us draw near hither unto God.* Then Saul said, "Let us go down after the Philistines by night and plunder them until the morning light. Let us not leave a man of them." And they said, "Do whatever seems good to you." But the priest said, "Let us draw near to God here."
- 37 *And Saul asked counsel of God, Shall I go down after the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into the hand of Israel? But he answered him not that day.* Saul inquired of God, "Shall I go down after the Philistines? Will you give them into the hand of Israel?" But He did not answer Him that day.
- 38 *And Saul said, Draw ye near hither, all the chief of the people: and know and see wherein this sin hath been this day.* Saul said, "Come here, all you leaders of the people, and know and see how this sin has arisen today.
- 39 *For, as the LORD liveth, which saveth Israel, though it be in Jonathan my son, he shall surely die. But there was not a man among all the people that answered him.* For as the LORD lives who saves Israel, though it be in Jonathan my son, he shall surely die." But there was not a man among all the people who answered him.

- 40 *Then said he unto all Israel, Be ye on one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side. And the people said unto Saul, Do what seemeth good unto thee.* Then he said to all Israel, "You shall be on one side. I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side." And the people said to Saul, "Do what seems good to you."
- 41 *Therefore Saul said unto the LORD God of Israel, Give a perfect lot. And Saul and Jonathan were taken: but the people escaped.* Therefore Saul said to the LORD God of Israel, "Give a perfect lot." And Saul and Jonathan were taken, but the people escaped.
- 42 *And Saul said, Cast lots between me and Jonathan my son. And Jonathan was taken.* Then Saul said, "Cast the lot between me and my son Jonathan." And Jonathan was taken.
- 43 *Then Saul said to Jonathan, Tell me what thou hast done. And Jonathan told him, and said, I did but taste a little honey with the end of the rod that was in mine hand, and, lo, I must die.* Then Saul said to Jonathan, "Tell me what you have done." And Jonathan told him, "I tasted a little honey with the tip of the staff that was in my hand. Here I am; I will die."
- 44 *And Saul answered, God do so and more also: for thou shalt surely die, Jonathan.* Saul said, "God do so to me and more also; you shall surely die, Jonathan."
- 45 *And the people said unto Saul, Shall Jonathan die, who hath wrought this great salvation in Israel? God forbid: as the LORD liveth, there shall not one hair of his head fall to the ground; for he hath wrought with God this day. So the people rescued Jonathan, that he died not.* Then the people said to Saul, "Shall Jonathan die, who has worked this great salvation in Israel? Far from it! As the LORD lives, not one hair of his head shall fall to the ground, for he has worked with God this day." So the people ransomed Jonathan. He did not die.
- 46 *Then Saul went up from following the Philistines: and the Philistines went to their own place.* Then Saul went up from pursuing the Philistines, and the Philistines went to their own place.

- 47 *So Saul took the kingdom over Israel, and fought against all his enemies on every side, against Moab, and against the children of Ammon, and against Edom, and against the kings of Zobah, and against the Philistines: and whithersoever he turned himself, he vexed them.* When Saul had taken the kingship over Israel, he fought against all his enemies on every side, against Moab, against the Ammonites, against Edom, against the kings of Zobah, and against the Philistines. Wherever he turned he routed them.
- 48 *And he gathered an host, and smote the Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the hands of them that spoiled them.* He did valiantly and struck the Amalekites and delivered Israel out of the hands of those who plundered them.
- 49 *Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan, and Ishui, and Melchishua: and the names of his two daughters were these; the name of the firstborn Merab, and the name of the younger Michal:* Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan, Ishvi, and Malchi-shua. And the names of his two daughters: the name of the firstborn was Merab, and the name of the younger Michal.
- 50 *And the name of Saul's wife was Ahinoam, the daughter of Ahimaaz: and the name of the captain of his host was Abner, the son of Ner, Saul's uncle.* The name of Saul's wife was Ahinoam the daughter of Ahimaaz. And the name of the commander of his army was Abner the son of Ner, Saul's uncle.
- 51 *And Kish was the father of Saul; and Ner the father of Abner was the son of Abiel.* Kish was the father of Saul, and Ner the father of Abner was the son of Abiel.
- 52 *And there was sore war against the Philistines all the days of Saul: and when Saul saw any strong man, or any valiant man, he took him unto him.* There was hard fighting against the Philistines all the days of Saul. And when Saul saw any strong man, or any valiant man, he attached him to himself.

Words in this chapter:

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

- v3** — 1 Sam 4:21; 1 Sam 22:20; 1 Sam 2:28
v6 — Matt 19:26; Rom 8:31; Zech 4:6; Deut 32:30
v20 — Judg 7:22; 2 Chr 20:23
v21 — 1 Sam 29:4
v23 — Ex 14:30; 1 Sam 13:5
v32 — Lev 3:17; 1 Sam 15:19
v35 — 1 Sam 7:17
v37 — 1 Sam 28:6
v41 — Acts 1:24; Josh 7:16-18; 1 Sam 10:20-21
v44 — 1 Sam 14:39; Ruth 1:17
v45 — Acts 27:34; Luke 21:18; 2 Sam 14:11; 1 Kgs 1:52
v49 — 1 Sam 31:2; 1 Chr 8:33

Chapter 15

God commanded Saul to utterly destroy the Amalekites, but Saul spared King Agag and the best livestock. Samuel declared that obedience is better than sacrifice, and the LORD rejected Saul as king; Samuel hewed Agag to pieces.

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| <p>1 Samuel also said unto Saul, <i>The LORD sent me to anoint thee to be king over his people, over Israel: now therefore hearken thou unto the voice of the words of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Samuel said to Saul, "The LORD sent me to anoint you king over his people Israel; now therefore listen to the words of the LORD.</p> |
| <p>2 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, <i>I remember that which Amalek did to Israel, how he laid wait for him in the way, when he came up from Egypt.</i></p> | <p>Thus says the LORD of hosts, 'I have noted what Amalek did to Israel in opposing them on the way when they came up out of Egypt.</p> |
| <p>3 Now go and smite Amalek, and utterly destroy all that they have, and spare them not; but slay both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.</p> | <p>Now go and strike Amalek and devote to destruction all that they have. Do not spare them, but kill both man and woman, child and infant, ox and sheep, camel and donkey.' "</p> |
| <p>4 And Saul gathered the people together, and numbered them in Telaim, two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand men of Judah.</p> | <p>So Saul summoned the people and numbered them at Telaim, two hundred thousand foot soldiers and ten thousand men of Judah.</p> |

- 5 *And Saul came to a city of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley.* Saul came to the city of Amalek and lay in wait in the valley.
- 6 *And Saul said unto the Kenites, Go, depart, get you down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them: for ye shewed kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites.* Then Saul said to the Kenites, "Go, depart; go down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them. For you showed kindness to all the people of Israel when they came up out of Egypt." So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites.
- 7 *And Saul smote the Amalekites from Havilah until thou comest to Shur, that is over against Egypt.* Saul defeated the Amalekites from Havilah as far as Shur, which is east of Egypt.
- 8 *And he took Agag the king of the Amalekites alive, and utterly destroyed all the people with the edge of the sword.* He took Agag the king of the Amalekites alive and devoted to destruction all the people with the edge of the sword.
- 9 *But Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the sheep, and of the oxen, and of the fatlings, and the lambs, and all that was good, and would not utterly destroy them: but every thing that was vile and refuse, that they destroyed utterly.* But Saul and the people spared Agag and the best of the sheep and of the oxen and of the fattened calves and the lambs. All that was good, and would not devote them to destruction. All that was despised and worthless they devoted to destruction.
- 10 *Then came the word of the LORD unto Samuel, saying,* The word of the LORD came to Samuel:
- 11 *It repenteth me that I have set up Saul to be king: for he is turned back from following me, and hath not performed my commandments. And it grieved Samuel; and he cried unto the LORD all night.* "I regret that I have made Saul king, for he has turned back from following me and has not performed my commandments." And Samuel was angry. He cried to the LORD all night.

- 12 *And when Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the morning, it was told Samuel, saying, Saul came to Carmel, and, behold, he set him up a place, and is gone about, and passed on, and gone down to Gilgal.* Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the morning. And it was told Samuel, "Saul came to Carmel, and see, he has set up a monument for himself and turned and passed on and gone down to Gilgal."
- 13 *And Samuel came to Saul: and Saul said unto him, Blessed be thou of the LORD: I have performed the commandment of the LORD.* Samuel came to Saul, and Saul said to him, "Blessed be you to the LORD. I have performed the commandment of the LORD."
- 14 *And Samuel said, What meaneth then this bleating of the sheep in mine ears, and the lowing of the oxen which I hear?* Samuel said, "What then is this bleating of the sheep in my ears and the lowing of the oxen that I hear?"
- 15 *And Saul said, They have brought them from the Amalekites: for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the oxen, to sacrifice unto the LORD thy God; and the rest we have utterly destroyed.* Saul said, "They have brought them from the Amalekites, for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the oxen to sacrifice to the LORD Your God, and the rest we have devoted to destruction."
- 16 *Then Samuel said unto Saul, Stay, and I will tell thee what the LORD hath said to me this night. And he said unto him, Say on.* Then Samuel said to Saul, "Stop! I will tell you what the LORD said to me this night." And he said to him, "Speak."
- 17 *And Samuel said, When thou wast little in thine own sight, wast thou not made the head of the tribes of Israel, and the LORD anointed thee king over Israel?* Samuel said, "Though you are small in your own eyes, are You not the head of the tribes of Israel? The LORD anointed You king over Israel."
- 18 *And the LORD sent thee on a journey, and said, Go and utterly destroy the sinners the Amalekites, and fight against them until they be consumed.* The LORD sent You on a mission and said, 'Go, devote to destruction the sinners, the Amalekites, and fight against them until they are consumed.'

- 19 *Wherefore then didst thou not obey the voice of the LORD, but didst fly upon the spoil, and didst evil in the sight of the LORD?* Why then did You not obey the voice of the LORD? Why did You pounce on the spoil and do what was evil in the sight of the LORD?"
- 20 *And Saul said unto Samuel, Yea, I have obeyed the voice of the LORD, and have gone the way which the LORD sent me, and have brought Agag the king of Amalek, and have utterly destroyed the Amalekites.* Saul said to Samuel, "I have obeyed the voice of the LORD. I have gone on the mission on which the LORD sent me. I have brought Agag the king of Amalek. I have devoted the Amalekites to destruction.
- 21 *But the people took of the spoil, sheep and oxen, the chief of the things which should have been utterly destroyed, to sacrifice unto the LORD thy God in Gilgal.* But the people took of the spoil, sheep and oxen, the best of the things devoted to destruction, to sacrifice to the LORD Your God in Gilgal."
- 22 *And Samuel said, Hath the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the LORD? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.* Samuel said, "Has the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the LORD? See, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen than the fat of rams.
- 23 *For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and stubbornness is as iniquity and idolatry. Because thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, he hath also rejected thee from being king.* For rebellion is as the sin of divination, and presumption is as iniquity and idolatry. Because You have rejected the word of the LORD, He has also rejected You from being king."
- 24 *And Saul said unto Samuel, I have sinned: for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD, and thy words: because I feared the people, and obeyed their voice.* Saul said to Samuel, "I have sinned, for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD and your words, because I feared the people and obeyed their voice.
- 25 *Now therefore, I pray thee, pardon my sin, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD.* Now therefore, please pardon my sin and return with me that I may worship the LORD."

- 26 *And Samuel said unto Saul, I will not return with thee: for thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, and the LORD hath rejected thee from being king over Israel.* Samuel said to Saul, "I will not return with you. For you have rejected the word of the LORD. The LORD has rejected you from being king over Israel."
- 27 *And as Samuel turned about to go away, he laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent.* As Samuel turned to go away, Saul seized the hem of his robe. It tore.
- 28 *And Samuel said unto him, The LORD hath rent the kingdom of Israel from thee this day, and hath given it to a neighbour of thine, that is better than thou.* Samuel said to him, "The LORD has torn the kingdom of Israel from You this day and has given it to a neighbor of Yours, who is better than You.
- 29 *And also the Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent: for he is not a man, that he should repent.* Also the Glory of Israel will not lie or have regret, for He is not a man, that he should have regret."
- 30 *Then he said, I have sinned: yet honour me now, I pray thee, before the elders of my people, and before Israel, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD thy God.* Then He said, "I have sinned; yet honor me now before the elders of my people and before Israel, and return with me, that I may bow before the LORD Your God."
- 31 *So Samuel turned again after Saul; and Saul worshipped the LORD.* So Samuel turned back after Saul, and Saul bowed before the LORD.
- 32 *Then said Samuel, Bring ye hither to me Agag the king of the Amalekites. And Agag came unto him delicately. And Agag said, Surely the bitterness of death is past.* Then Samuel said, "Bring here to me Agag the king of the Amalekites." And Agag came to him cheerfully. Agag said, "Surely the bitterness of death is past."
- 33 *And Samuel said, As thy sword hath made women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And Samuel hewed Agag in pieces before the LORD in Gilgal.* Samuel said, "As your sword has made women childless, so shall Your mother be childless among women." And Samuel hacked Agag to pieces before the LORD in Gilgal.

- 34 *Then Samuel went to Ramah; and Saul went up to his house to Gibeah of Saul.* Then Samuel went to Ramah, and Saul went up to his house at Gibeah of Saul.
- 35 *And Samuel came no more to see Saul until the day of his death: nevertheless Samuel mourned for Saul: and the LORD repented that he had made Saul king over Israel.* Samuel did not see Saul again until the day of his death, but Samuel grieved over Saul. And the LORD regretted that He had made Saul king over Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 25:17-19; Ex 17:8-16; Num 24:20
v3 — Deut 20:16-18; Num 24:20
v7 — 1 Sam 14:48; Gen 25:18; Gen 16:7
v11 — 1 Sam 13:13; Gen 6:6; 2 Sam 24:16; Ps 119:136
v17 — 1 Sam 15:1-3; 1 Sam 10:22; 1 Sam 9:21; 1 Sam 10:1
v22 — Hos 6:6; Ps 51:16-17; Prov 21:3; Amos 5:21-24; Mark 12:33
v23 — Jer 28:16; 1 Sam 13:14; Lev 20:6; Gal 5:20; 2 Cor 6:16
v24 — 2 Sam 12:13; Isa 51:12-13
v26 — Hos 4:6; 1 Sam 13:14; 1 Sam 16:1; 1 Sam 15:23; 2 John 1:11
v29 — Num 23:19; Ezek 24:14; Titus 1:2; 2 Tim 2:13; Heb 6:18
v30 — John 12:43; John 5:44; Isa 29:13
v33 — Judg 1:7; Gen 9:6

Chapter 16

The LORD sent Samuel to Bethlehem to anoint David, the youngest son of Jesse, as the next king. The Spirit of the LORD departed from Saul, and an evil spirit troubled him; David was brought to court as a musician to soothe Saul.

- 1 *And the LORD said unto Samuel, How long wilt thou mourn for Saul, seeing I have rejected him from reigning over Israel? fill thine horn with oil, and go, I will send thee to Jesse the Bethlehemite: for I have provided me a king among his sons.* The LORD said to Samuel, "How long will you grieve over Saul, since I have rejected him from being king over Israel? Fill your horn with oil, and go. I will send you to Jesse the Bethlehemite, for I have provided for myself a king among his sons."

■ **NAME NOTE** — *Jesse (JES-ee) — "wealthy" — Father of David, grandson of Boaz and Ruth, an Ephrathite of Bethlehem. From his line came the royal house of Judah. Isaiah prophesied that a Branch would grow from "the stem of Jesse" (Isaiah 11:1).*

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| <p>2 <i>And Samuel said, How can I go? if Saul hear it, he will kill me. And the LORD said, Take an heifer with thee, and say, I am come to sacrifice to the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Samuel said, "How can I go? If Saul hears it, he will kill me." And the LORD said, "Take a heifer with You and say, 'I have come to sacrifice to the LORD.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And call Jesse to the sacrifice, and I will shew thee what thou shalt do: and thou shalt anoint unto me him whom I name unto thee.</i></p> | <p>Invite Jesse to the sacrifice. I will show You what You shall do. And You shall anoint for me Him whom I declare to You."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Samuel did that which the LORD spake, and came to Bethlehem. And the elders of the town trembled at his coming, and said, Comest thou peaceably?</i></p> | <p>Samuel did what the LORD commanded and came to Bethlehem. The elders of the city came to meet Him trembling and said, "Do You come peaceably?"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And he said, Peaceably: I am come to sacrifice unto the LORD: sanctify yourselves, and come with me to the sacrifice. And he sanctified Jesse and his sons, and called them to the sacrifice.</i></p> | <p>He said, "Peaceably; I have come to sacrifice to the LORD. Consecrate yourselves, and come with me to the sacrifice." And He consecrated Jesse and His sons and invited them to the sacrifice.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And it came to pass, when they were come, that he looked on Eliab, and said, Surely the LORD'S anointed is before him.</i></p> | <p>When they came, He looked on Eliab and thought, "Surely the LORD's anointed is before Him."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his countenance, or on the height of his stature; because I have refused him: for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.</i></p> | <p>But the LORD said to Samuel, "Do not look on his appearance or on the height of his stature, because I have rejected him. For the LORD sees not as man sees: man looks on the outward appearance. But the LORD looks on the heart."</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>Then Jesse called Abinadab, and made him pass before Samuel. And he said, Neither hath the LORD chosen this.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Then Jesse made Shammah to pass by. And he said, Neither hath the LORD chosen this.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Again, Jesse made seven of his sons to pass before Samuel. And Samuel said unto Jesse, The LORD hath not chosen these.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Samuel said unto Jesse, Are here all thy children? And he said, There remaineth yet the youngest, and, behold, he keepeth the sheep. And Samuel said unto Jesse, Send and fetch him: for we will not sit down till he come hither.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And he sent, and brought him in. Now he was ruddy, and withal of a beautiful countenance, and goodly to look to. And the LORD said, Arise, anoint him: for this is he.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him in the midst of his brethren: and the Spirit of the LORD came upon David from that day forward. So Samuel rose up, and went to Ramah.</i></p> | <p>Then Jesse called Abinadab and made Him pass before Samuel. And he said, "Neither has the LORD chosen this one."</p> <p>Then Jesse made Shammah pass by. And He said, "Neither has the LORD chosen this one."</p> <p>Jesse made seven of His sons pass before Samuel. And Samuel said to Jesse, "The LORD has not chosen these."</p> <p>Then Samuel said to Jesse, "Are all your sons here?" And he said, "There remains yet the youngest. But he is keeping the sheep." And Samuel said to Jesse, "Send and get him, for we will not sit down until he comes here."</p> <p>He sent and brought Him in. Now He was ruddy and had a beautiful countenance and was handsome. And the LORD said, "Arise, anoint Him, for this is He."</p> <p>Then Samuel took the horn of oil and anointed him in the midst of His brothers. And the Spirit of the LORD rushed upon David from that day forward. And Samuel rose up and went to Ramah.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **David** (DAY-vid) — "beloved" — Youngest son of Jesse of Bethlehem, anointed king as a shepherd boy. Israel's greatest king, the "man after God's own heart" (13:14), warrior, psalmist, and ancestor of Jesus Christ. God made with him an everlasting covenant that his throne would endure forever (2 Samuel 7).

- 14 *But the Spirit of the LORD departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the LORD troubled him.* Now the Spirit of the LORD departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the LORD tormented Him.
- 15 *And Saul's servants said unto him, Behold now, an evil spirit from God troubleth thee.* Saul's servants said to him, "See, an evil spirit from God is tormenting you.
- 16 *Let our lord now command thy servants, which are before thee, to seek out a man, who is a cunning player on an harp: and it shall come to pass, when the evil spirit from God is upon thee, that he shall play with his hand, and thou shalt be well.* Let our lord now command your servants who are before you to seek out a man who is skillful in playing the lyre, and when the evil spirit from God is upon you, He will play it, and you will be well."
- 17 *And Saul said unto his servants, Provide me now a man that can play well, and bring him to me.* So Saul said to his servants, "Provide for me a man who can play well and bring him to me."
- 18 *Then answered one of the servants, and said, Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite, that is cunning in playing, and a mighty valiant man, and a man of war, and prudent in matters, and a comely person, and the LORD is with him.* One of the young men answered, "I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite, who is skillful in playing, a man of valor, a man of war, prudent in speech, and a man of good presence. The LORD is with Him."
- 19 *Wherefore Saul sent messengers unto Jesse, and said, Send me David thy son, which is with the sheep.* Therefore Saul sent messengers to Jesse and said, "Send me David your son, who is with the sheep."
- 20 *And Jesse took an ass laden with bread, and a bottle of wine, and a kid, and sent them by David his son unto Saul.* Jesse took a donkey loaded with bread and a skin of wine and a young goat and sent them by David his son to Saul.
- 21 *And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him greatly; and he became his armourbearer.* David came to Saul and entered his service. And Saul loved him greatly. He became his armor-bearer.

- 22 *And Saul sent to Jesse, saying, Let David, I pray thee, stand before me; for he hath found favour in my sight.* Saul sent to Jesse, saying, "Let David remain in my service, for he has found favor in my sight."
- 23 *And it came to pass, when the evil spirit from God was upon Saul, that David took an harp, and played with his hand: so Saul was refreshed, and was well, and the evil spirit departed from him.* Whenever the evil spirit from God was upon Saul, David took the lyre and played it with his hand. So Saul was refreshed and was well, and the evil spirit departed from him.

Words in this chapter:

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Kgs 9:1; 1 Sam 15:23; Ps 78:68-71; 1 Sam 15:35; 1 Sam 16:15
v2 — 1 Sam 9:12
v3 — 1 Sam 9:16
v4 — 1 Kgs 2:13
v7 — John 7:24; Jer 17:10; Luke 16:15; 1 Pet 3:4; Isa 55:8-9
v8 — 1 Sam 17:13
v11 — Ps 78:70-71; 2 Sam 7:8
v13 — 1 Sam 10:6; Heb 1:9; John 3:34; 1 Sam 10:1; Judg 11:29
v14 — Ps 51:11; 1 Sam 18:12; Judg 9:23; 1 Sam 28:15; 1 Sam 18:10
v16 — 2 Kgs 3:15; 1 Kgs 10:8
v18 — 1 Sam 3:19; Gen 39:23; 1 Sam 17:32-36; Gen 39:2; 1 Sam 10:7
v21 — Gen 41:46; Prov 22:29

Chapter 17

The Philistine giant Goliath challenged Israel to single combat for forty days. David, a young shepherd, went out against him with a sling and five stones, struck him in the forehead, and killed him; the Philistines fled and Israel pursued them.

- 1 *Now the Philistines gathered together their armies to battle, and were gathered together at Shochoh, which belongeth to Judah, and pitched between Shochoh and Azekah, in Ephesdammin.* Now the Philistines gathered their forces for battle and were assembled at Socoh, which belongs to Judah, and encamped between Socoh and Azekah, in Ephes-dammim.

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| 2 | <i>And Saul and the men of Israel were gathered together, and pitched by the valley of Elah, and set the battle in array against the Philistines.</i> | Saul and the men of Israel were gathered and encamped in the Valley of Elah and drew up in line against the Philistines. |
| 3 | <i>And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side, and Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them.</i> | The Philistines stood on the mountain on the one side. Israel stood on the mountain on the other side, with a valley between them. |
| 4 | <i>And there went out a champion out of the camp of the Philistines, named Goliath, of Gath, whose height was six cubits and a span.</i> | There came out from the camp of the Philistines a champion named Goliath of Gath, whose height was six cubits and a span. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Goliath** (guh-LY-ath) — "exile, splendor" — A giant warrior of Gath, champion of the Philistines, standing over nine feet tall. For forty days he defied the armies of Israel until the shepherd boy David killed him with a sling and a stone in the name of the LORD of hosts.

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| 5 | <i>And he had an helmet of brass upon his head, and he was armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of brass.</i> | He had a helmet of bronze on His head. He was armed with a coat of mail. The weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of bronze. |
| 6 | <i>And he had greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target of brass between his shoulders.</i> | He had bronze armor on His legs, and a javelin of bronze slung between His shoulders. |
| 7 | <i>And the staff of his spear was like a weaver's beam; and his spear's head weighed six hundred shekels of iron: and one bearing a shield went before him.</i> | The shaft of his spear was like a weaver's beam. his spear's head weighed six hundred shekels of iron. And his shield-bearer went before Him. |
| 8 | <i>And he stood and cried unto the armies of Israel, and said unto them, Why are ye come out to set your battle in array? am not I a Philistine, and ye servants to Saul? choose you a man for you, and let him come down to me.</i> | He stood and shouted to the ranks of Israel, "Why have you come out to draw up for battle? Am I not a Philistine, and are you not servants of Saul? Choose a man for yourselves, and let him come down to me. |

- 9 *If he be able to fight with me, and to kill me, then will we be your servants: but if I prevail against him, and kill him, then shall ye be our servants, and serve us.* If he is able to fight with me and kill me, then we will be your servants. But if I prevail against him and kill him, then you shall be our servants and serve us."
- 10 *And the Philistine said, I defy the armies of Israel this day; give me a man, that we may fight together.* The Philistine said, "I defy the ranks of Israel this day. Give me a man, that we may fight together."
- 11 *When Saul and all Israel heard those words of the Philistine, they were dismayed, and greatly afraid.* When Saul and all Israel heard these words of the Philistine, they were dismayed and greatly afraid.
- 12 *Now David was the son of that Ephrathite of Bethlehemjudah, whose name was Jesse; and he had eight sons: and the man went among men for an old man in the days of Saul.* Now David was the son of an Ephrathite of Bethlehem in Judah, named Jesse, who had eight sons. In the days of Saul the man was already old and advanced in years.
- 13 *And the three eldest sons of Jesse went and followed Saul to the battle: and the names of his three sons that went to the battle were Eliab the firstborn, and next unto him Abinadab, and the third Shammah.* The three oldest sons of Jesse had followed Saul to the battle. And the names of his three sons who went to the battle were Eliab the firstborn, and next to him Abinadab, and the third Shammah.
- 14 *And David was the youngest: and the three eldest followed Saul.* David was the youngest. The three oldest followed Saul,
- 15 *But David went and returned from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem.* But David went back and forth from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem.
- 16 *And the Philistine drew near morning and evening, and presented himself forty days.* For forty days the Philistine came forward and took his stand, morning and evening.

- 17 *And Jesse said unto David his son, Take now for thy brethren an ephah of this parched corn, and these ten loaves, and run to the camp to thy brethren;* Jesse said to David his son, "Take for your brothers an ephah of this parched grain, and these ten loaves, and carry them quickly to the camp to your brothers.
- 18 *And carry these ten cheeses unto the captain of their thousand, and look how thy brethren fare, and take their pledge.* Also take these ten cuts of cheese to the commander of their thousand. See how your brothers are and bring some token from them."
- 19 *Now Saul, and they, and all the men of Israel, were in the valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines.* Now Saul and they and all the men of Israel were in the Valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines.
- 20 *And David rose up early in the morning, and left the sheep with a keeper, and took, and went, as Jesse had commanded him; and he came to the trench, as the host was going forth to the fight, and shouted for the battle.* David rose early in the morning and left the sheep with a keeper and took the provisions and went, as Jesse had commanded him. And he came to the encampment as the army was going out to the battle line, shouting the war cry.
- 21 *And Israel and the Philistines had put the battle in array, army against army.* Israel and the Philistines drew up for battle, army against army.
- 22 *And David left his carriage in the hand of the keeper of the carriage, and ran into the army, and came and saluted his brethren.* David left the things in charge of the keeper of the baggage and ran to the ranks and went and greeted his brothers.
- 23 *And as he talked with them, behold, there came up the champion, the Philistine of Gath, Goliath by name, out of the armies of the Philistines, and spake according to the same words: and David heard them.* As he talked with them, Goliath the Philistine champion of Gath came up out of the ranks of the Philistines and spoke the same words as before. And David heard him.
- 24 *And all the men of Israel, when they saw the man, fled from him, and were sore afraid.* All the men of Israel, when they saw the man, fled from him and were greatly afraid.

- 25 *And the men of Israel said, Have ye seen this man that is come up? surely to defy Israel is he come up: and it shall be, that the man who killeth him, the king will enrich him with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and make his father's house free in Israel.* The men of Israel said, "Have you seen this man who has come up? Surely he has come up to defy Israel. And the king will enrich the man who kills him with great riches and will give him his daughter and make his father's house free in Israel."
- 26 *And David spake to the men that stood by him, saying, What shall be done to the man that killeth this Philistine, and taketh away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?* David said to the men who stood by him, "What shall be done for the man who kills this Philistine and takes away the reproach from Israel? For who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?"
- 27 *And the people answered him after this manner, saying, So shall it be done to the man that killeth him.* The people answered him in the same way, "So shall it be done to the man who kills him."
- 28 *And Eliab his eldest brother heard when he spake unto the men; and Eliab's anger was kindled against David, and he said, Why camest thou down hither? and with whom hast thou left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know thy pride, and the naughtiness of thine heart; for thou art come down that thou mightest see the battle.* Now Eliab his eldest brother heard when he spoke to the men. And Eliab's anger was kindled against David. He said, "Why have you come down here? And with whom have you left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know your presumption and the evil of your heart, for you have come down to see the battle."
- 29 *And David said, What have I now done? Is there not a cause?* David said, "What have I done now? Was it not just a question?"
- 30 *And he turned from him toward another, and spake after the same manner: and the people answered him again after the former manner.* He turned away from him toward another, and spoke in the same way, and the people answered him again as before.

- 31 *And when the words were heard which David spake, they rehearsed them before Saul: and he sent for him.* When the words that David spoke were heard, they repeated them before Saul. He sent for him.
- 32 *And David said to Saul, Let no man's heart fail because of him; thy servant will go and fight with this Philistine.* David said to Saul, "Let no man's heart fail because of him. Your servant will go and fight with this Philistine."
- 33 *And Saul said to David, Thou art not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him: for thou art but a youth, and he a man of war from his youth.* Saul said to David, "You are not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him, for you are but a youth. He has been a man of war from his youth."
- 34 *And David said unto Saul, Thy servant kept his father's sheep, and there came a lion, and a bear, and took a lamb out of the flock:* But David said to Saul, "Your servant used to keep sheep for his father. And when there came a lion, or a bear, and took a lamb from the flock,
- 35 *And I went out after him, and smote him, and delivered it out of his mouth: and when he arose against me, I caught him by his beard, and smote him, and slew him.* I went after it and struck it and delivered the lamb out of its mouth. And if it arose against me, I caught it by its beard and struck it and killed it.
- 36 *Thy servant slew both the lion and the bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, seeing he hath defied the armies of the living God.* Your servant has struck down both lions and bears, and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be like one of them, for he has defied the armies of the living God."
- 37 *David said moreover, The LORD that delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine. And Saul said unto David, Go, and the LORD be with thee.* David said, "The LORD who delivered me from the paw of the lion and from the paw of the bear will deliver me from the hand of this Philistine." And Saul said to David, "Go. The LORD be with you!"

- 38 *And Saul armed David with his armour, and he put an helmet of brass upon his head; also he armed him with a coat of mail.* Then Saul clothed David with his armor. He put a helmet of bronze on his head and clothed him with a coat of mail,
- 39 *And David girded his sword upon his armour, and he assayed to go; for he had not proved it. And David said unto Saul, I cannot go with these; for I have not proved them. And David put them off him.* David strapped his sword over his armor. And he tried in vain to go, for he had not tested them. Then David said to Saul, "I cannot go with these, for I have not tested them." So David put them off.
- 40 *And he took his staff in his hand, and chose him five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them in a shepherd's bag which he had, even in a scrip; and his sling was in his hand: and he drew near to the Philistine.* Then he took his staff in his hand and chose five smooth stones from the brook and put them in his shepherd's pouch. His sling was in his hand. He approached the Philistine.
- 41 *And the Philistine came on and drew near unto David; and the man that bare the shield went before him.* The Philistine moved forward and came near to David, with his shield-bearer in front of him.
- 42 *And when the Philistine looked about, and saw David, he disdained him: for he was but a youth, and ruddy, and of a fair countenance.* When the Philistine looked and saw David, he disdained him, for he was but a youth, ruddy and of a fair countenance.
- 43 *And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods.* The Philistine said to David, "Am I a dog, that you come to me with sticks?" And the Philistine cursed David by his gods.
- 44 *And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field.* The Philistine said to David, "Come to me. I will give your flesh to the birds of the air and to the beasts of the field."

- 45 *Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied.* Then David said to the Philistine, "You come to me with a sword and with a spear and with a javelin. But I come to You in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom You have defied.
- 46 *This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcasses of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel.* This day the LORD will deliver You into my hand. I will strike You down and cut off Your head. And I will give the dead bodies of the host of the Philistines this day to the birds of the air and to the wild beasts of the earth, that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel,
- 47 *And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD'S, and he will give you into our hands.* That all this assembly may know that the LORD saves not with sword and spear. For the battle is the LORD's. He will give You into our hand."
- 48 *And it came to pass, when the Philistine arose, and came and drew nigh to meet David, that David hasted, and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine.* When the Philistine arose and came and drew near to meet David, David ran quickly toward the battle line to meet the Philistine.
- 49 *And David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine in his forehead, that the stone sunk into his forehead; and he fell upon his face to the earth.* David put his hand in his bag and took out a stone and slung it and struck the Philistine on his forehead. The stone sank into his forehead. He fell on his face to the ground.
- 50 *So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.* So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and struck the Philistine and killed him. There was no sword in the hand of David.

- 51 *Therefore David ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and slew him, and cut off his head therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled.* Then David ran and stood over the Philistine and took his sword and drew it out of its sheath and killed him and cut off his head with it. When the Philistines saw that their champion was dead, they fled.
- 52 *And the men of Israel and of Judah arose, and shouted, and pursued the Philistines, until thou come to the valley, and to the gates of Ekron. And the wounded of the Philistines fell down by the way to Shaaraim, even unto Gath, and unto Ekron.* The men of Israel and Judah rose with a shout and pursued the Philistines until they came to the valley and to the gates of Ekron, so that the wounded Philistines fell on the way from Shaaraim as far as Gath and Ekron.
- 53 *And the children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines, and they spoiled their tents.* The people of Israel came back from chasing the Philistines. They plundered their camp.
- 54 *And David took the head of the Philistine, and brought it to Jerusalem; but he put his armour in his tent.* David took the head of the Philistine and brought it to Jerusalem. But he put his armor in his tent.
- 55 *And when Saul saw David go forth against the Philistine, he said unto Abner, the captain of the host, Abner, whose son is this youth? And Abner said, As thy soul liveth, O king, I cannot tell.* As soon as Saul saw David go out against the Philistine, he said to Abner, the commander of the army, "Abner, whose son is this youth?" And Abner said, "As your soul lives, O king, I do not know."
- 56 *And the king said, Enquire thou whose son the stripling is.* The king said, "Inquire whose son the boy is."
- 57 *And as David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, Abner took him, and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand.* As David returned from the striking down of the Philistine, Abner took him and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand.

- 58 *And Saul said to him, Whose son art thou, thou young man? And David answered, I am the son of thy servant Jesse the Bethlehemite.* Saul said to him, "Whose son are you, young man?" And David answered, "I am the son of your servant Jesse the Bethlehemite."
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Words in this chapter:

carriage — Baggage or belongings carried on a journey — not a vehicle; 'they left their carriages' means they left their gear behind.

Goliath (*go-LY-ath*) — The Philistine giant from Gath — over nine feet tall; defeated by the young David with a stone and sling; symbol of enemies too great for human strength.

Cross-References:

- v10** — 1 Sam 17:25-26; 1 Sam 17:36; 1 Sam 17:45
v12 — Gen 35:19; 1 Sam 16:10-11; 1 Sam 16:18
v26 — Deut 5:26; 1 Sam 11:2; 1 Sam 17:36; 1 Sam 14:6; 1 Sam 17:10
v28 — Matt 10:36; Gen 37:11; Prov 18:19; Gen 37:8; Gen 37:4
v32 — 1 Sam 16:18; Deut 20:1-3; Ps 3:6; Isa 35:4
v35 — 2 Tim 4:17-18; Amos 3:12
v37 — 2 Tim 4:17-18; Ps 138:7-8; 2 Cor 1:9-10; Ps 18:16-17; Ps 63:7
v43 — 2 Sam 3:8; 1 Sam 24:14; 2 Sam 9:8
v45 — 2 Cor 10:4; 2 Chr 32:8; 2 Cor 3:5; Phil 4:13; Ps 18:2
v46 — Isa 52:10; Josh 4:24; 2 Kgs 19:19; 1 Kgs 8:43; Deut 28:26
v47 — Ps 44:6-7; Zech 4:6; Hos 1:7; Prov 21:30-31; 1 Sam 14:6
v51 — 1 Sam 21:9; Heb 11:34

Chapter 18

Jonathan made a covenant of friendship with David, and David succeeded in everything Saul sent him to do. Saul became jealous when the women sang that David had slain his ten thousands, and he sought to kill David.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking unto Saul, that the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul.* As soon as he had finished speaking to Saul, the soul of Jonathan was knit to the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul.
- 2 *And Saul took him that day, and would let him go no more home to his father's house.* Saul took him that day and would not let him return to his father's house.

- 3 *Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul.* Then Jonathan made a covenant with David, because he loved him as his own soul.
- 4 *And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.* Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was on him and gave it to David, his armor, and even his sword and his bow and his belt.
- 5 *And David went out whithersoever Saul sent him, and behaved himself wisely: and Saul set him over the men of war, and he was accepted in the sight of all the people, and also in the sight of Saul's servants.* David went out and was successful wherever Saul sent him, so that Saul set him over the men of war. And this was good in the sight of all the people and also in the sight of Saul's servants.
- 6 *And it came to pass as they came, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, that the women came out of all cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet king Saul, with tabrets, with joy, and with instruments of musick.* As they were coming home, when David returned from striking down the Philistine, the women came out of all the cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet King Saul, with tambourines, with songs of joy, and with musical instruments.
- 7 *And the women answered one another as they played, and said, Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.* The women sang to one another as they celebrated, "Saul has struck down his thousands, and David his ten thousands."
- 8 *And Saul was very wroth, and the saying displeased him; and he said, They have ascribed unto David ten thousands, and to me they have ascribed but thousands: and what can he have more but the kingdom?* Saul was very angry, and this saying displeased him. He said, "They have ascribed to David ten thousands, and to me they have ascribed thousands, and what more can he have but the kingdom?"
- 9 *And Saul eyed David from that day and forward.* Saul eyed David from that day on.

- 10 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that the evil spirit from God came upon Saul, and he prophesied in the midst of the house: and David played with his hand, as at other times: and there was a javelin in Saul's hand.* The next day an evil spirit from God rushed upon Saul. He raved within his house while David was playing the lyre, as he did day by day. Saul had his spear in his hand.
- 11 *And Saul cast the javelin; for he said, I will smite David even to the wall with it. And David avoided out of his presence twice.* Saul hurled the spear, for he thought, "I will pin David to the wall." But David evaded him twice.
- 12 *And Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with him, and was departed from Saul.* Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with Him but had departed from Saul.
- 13 *Therefore Saul removed him from him, and made him his captain over a thousand; and he went out and came in before the people.* So Saul removed him from his presence and made him a commander of a thousand. And he went out and came in before the people.
- 14 *And David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and the LORD was with him.* David had success in all his undertakings, for the LORD was with Him.
- 15 *Wherefore when Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, he was afraid of him.* When Saul saw that he had great success, he stood in fearful awe of him.
- 16 *But all Israel and Judah loved David, because he went out and came in before them.* But all Israel and Judah loved David, for he went out and came in before them.
- 17 *And Saul said to David, Behold my elder daughter Merab, her will I give thee to wife: only be thou valiant for me, and fight the LORD'S battles. For Saul said, Let not mine hand be upon him, but let the hand of the Philistines be upon him.* Then Saul said to David, "Here is my elder daughter Merab. I will give her to you for a wife. Only be valiant for me and fight the LORD's battles." For Saul thought, "Let not my hand be against him, but let the hand of the Philistines be against Him."

- 18 *And David said unto Saul, Who am I? and what is my life, or my father's family in Israel, that I should be son in law to the king?* David said to Saul, "Who am I, and who are my relatives, my father's clan in Israel, that I should be son-in-law to the king?"
- 19 *But it came to pass at the time when Merab Saul's daughter should have been given to David, that she was given unto Adriel the Meholathite to wife.* But at the time when Merab, Saul's daughter, should have been given to David, she was given to Adriel the Meholathite for a wife.
- 20 *And Michal Saul's daughter loved David: and they told Saul, and the thing pleased him.* Now Michal, Saul's daughter, loved David. And they told Saul, and the thing pleased him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Michal** (MY-kal) — "who is like God?" — Saul's younger daughter who loved David and became his first wife. She helped David escape Saul by lowering him through a window. Later she despised David for dancing before the ark and was left childless.

- 21 *And Saul said, I will give him her, that she may be a snare to him, and that the hand of the Philistines may be against him. Wherefore Saul said to David, Thou shalt this day be my son in law in the one of the twain.* Saul thought, "Let me give her to him, that she may be a snare for him and that the hand of the Philistines may be against him." Therefore Saul said to David a second time, "You shall now be my son-in-law."
- 22 *And Saul commanded his servants, saying, Commune with David secretly, and say, Behold, the king hath delight in thee, and all his servants love thee: now therefore be the king's son in law.* Saul commanded his servants, "Speak to David privately and say, 'See, the king delights in you. All his servants love you. Now then become the king's son-in-law.' "
- 23 *And Saul's servants spake those words in the ears of David. And David said, Seemeth it to you a light thing to be a king's son in law, seeing that I am a poor man, and lightly esteemed?* Saul's servants spoke those words in the ears of David. And David said, "Does it seem to you a little thing to become the king's son-in-law, since I am a poor man and have no reputation?"
- 24 *And the servants of Saul told him, saying, On this manner spake David.* The servants of Saul told him, "Thus did David speak."

- 25 *And Saul said, Thus shall ye say to David, The king desireth not any dowry, but an hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be avenged of the king's enemies. But Saul thought to make David fall by the hand of the Philistines.* Then Saul said, "Thus shall you say to David, 'The king desires no bride-price except a hundred foreskins of the Philistines, that he may be avenged of the king's enemies.' " Now Saul planned to make David fall by the hand of the Philistines.
- 26 *And when his servants told David these words, it pleased David well to be the king's son in law: and the days were not expired.* When his servants told David these words, it pleased David well to be the king's son-in-law. Before the time had expired,
- 27 *Wherefore David arose and went, he and his men, and slew of the Philistines two hundred men; and David brought their foreskins, and they gave them in full tale to the king, that he might be the king's son in law. And Saul gave him Michal his daughter to wife.* David arose and went, along with his men, and killed two hundred of the Philistines. And David brought their foreskins, which were given in full number to the king, that he might become the king's son-in-law. And Saul gave him his daughter Michal for a wife.
- 28 *And Saul saw and knew that the LORD was with David, and that Michal Saul's daughter loved him.* But when Saul saw and knew that the LORD was with David, and that Michal, Saul's daughter, loved him,
- 29 *And Saul was yet the more afraid of David; and Saul became David's enemy continually.* Saul was still more afraid of David. So Saul was David's enemy continually.
- 30 *Then the princes of the Philistines went forth: and it came to pass, after they went forth, that David behaved himself more wisely than all the servants of Saul; so that his name was much set by.* Then the commanders of the Philistines came out to battle, and as often as they came out David had more success than all the servants of Saul, so that his name was highly esteemed.

Words in this chapter:

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 18:24; 1 Sam 20:17; 1 Sam 18:3; 2 Sam 1:26; Col 2:2
- v3 — 1 Sam 20:8-17; 1 Sam 20:42; 2 Sam 21:7
- v5 — 1 Sam 18:30; 1 Sam 18:14-15; Col 4:5
- v7 — 1 Sam 21:11; Ex 15:21; 1 Sam 29:5
- v10 — 2 Thess 2:11; 1 Sam 19:9; 1 Kgs 18:29
- v11 — 1 Sam 20:33; Isa 54:17
- v12 — 1 Sam 18:15; 1 Sam 18:29; 1 Sam 16:13-14; 1 Sam 28:15
- v14 — Gen 39:23; 1 Sam 16:18; Josh 6:27; Matt 28:20; Gen 39:2-3
- v17 — 1 Sam 25:28; 1 Sam 18:25; 1 Sam 17:25
- v18 — 2 Sam 7:18; 1 Sam 18:23; 1 Sam 9:21
- v25 — 1 Sam 18:17; 1 Sam 14:24; Gen 34:12
- v30 — 2 Sam 11:1; 1 Sam 18:5

Chapter 19

Saul ordered Jonathan and his servants to kill David, but Jonathan interceded for him. Saul tried twice to pin David to the wall with a spear, and Michal helped David escape through a window; David fled to Samuel at Ramah.

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| 1 | <i>And Saul spake to Jonathan his son, and to all his servants, that they should kill David.</i> | Saul spoke to Jonathan his son and to all his servants, that they should kill David. |
| 2 | <i>But Jonathan Saul's son delighted much in David: and Jonathan told David, saying, Saul my father seeketh to kill thee: now therefore, I pray thee, take heed to thyself until the morning, and abide in a secret place, and hide thyself:</i> | But Jonathan, Saul's son, delighted greatly in David. And Jonathan told David, "Saul my father seeks to kill you. Therefore be on your guard in the morning. Stay in a secret place and hide yourself. |
| 3 | <i>And I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where thou art, and I will commune with my father of thee; and what I see, that I will tell thee.</i> | I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where you are. I will speak to my father about you. And if I learn anything I will tell you." |

- 4 *And Jonathan spake good of David unto Saul his father, and said unto him, Let not the king sin against his servant, against David; because he hath not sinned against thee, and because his works have been to thee-ward very good:* Jonathan spoke well of David to Saul his father and said to him, "Let not the king sin against his servant David, because he has not sinned against you, and because his deeds have brought good to you.
- 5 *For he did put his life in his hand, and slew the Philistine, and the LORD wrought a great salvation for all Israel: thou sawest it, and didst rejoice: wherefore then wilt thou sin against innocent blood, to slay David without a cause?* For He took His life in His hand and He struck down the Philistine. The LORD worked a great salvation for all Israel. You saw it, and rejoiced. Why then will You sin against innocent blood by killing David without cause?"
- 6 *And Saul hearkened unto the voice of Jonathan: and Saul sware, As the LORD liveth, he shall not be slain.* Saul listened to the voice of Jonathan. Saul swore, "As the LORD lives, He shall not be put to death."
- 7 *And Jonathan called David, and Jonathan shewed him all those things. And Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was in his presence, as in times past.* Jonathan called David, and Jonathan reported to him all these things. And Jonathan brought David to Saul. He was in his presence as before.
- 8 *And there was war again: and David went out, and fought with the Philistines, and slew them with a great slaughter; and they fled from him.* There was war again. And David went out and fought with the Philistines and struck them with a great blow, so that they fled before him.
- 9 *And the evil spirit from the LORD was upon Saul, as he sat in his house with his javelin in his hand: and David played with his hand.* Then an evil spirit from the LORD came upon Saul, as he sat in his house with his spear in his hand. And David was playing the lyre.

- 10 *And Saul sought to smite David even to the wall with the javelin; but he slipped away out of Saul's presence, and he smote the javelin into the wall: and David fled, and escaped that night.* Saul sought to pin David to the wall with the spear. But he eluded Saul, so that he struck the spear into the wall. And David fled and escaped that night.
- 11 *Saul also sent messengers unto David's house, to watch him, and to slay him in the morning: and Michal David's wife told him, saying, If thou save not thy life to night, to morrow thou shalt be slain.* Saul sent messengers to David's house to watch him, that he might kill him in the morning. But Michal, David's wife, told him, "If you do not escape with your life tonight, tomorrow you will be killed."
- 12 *So Michal let David down through a window: and he went, and fled, and escaped.* So Michal let David down through the window. He fled away and escaped.
- 13 *And Michal took an image, and laid it in the bed, and put a pillow of goats' hair for his bolster, and covered it with a cloth.* Michal took an idol and laid it on the bed and put a pillow of goats' hair at its head and covered it with the clothes.
- 14 *And when Saul sent messengers to take David, she said, He is sick.* When Saul sent messengers to take David, she said, "He is sick."
- 15 *And Saul sent the messengers again to see David, saying, Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may slay him.* Then Saul sent the messengers to see David, saying, "Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may kill him."
- 16 *And when the messengers were come in, behold, there was an image in the bed, with a pillow of goats' hair for his bolster.* When the messengers came in, there was the idol in the bed, with the pillow of goats' hair at its head.
- 17 *And Saul said unto Michal, Why hast thou deceived me so, and sent away mine enemy, that he is escaped? And Michal answered Saul, He said unto me, Let me go; why should I kill thee?* Saul said to Michal, "Why have you deceived me like this and let my enemy go, so that he has escaped?" And Michal answered Saul, "He said to me, 'Let me go. Why should I kill you?'"

- 18 *So David fled, and escaped, and came to Samuel to Ramah, and told him all that Saul had done to him. And he and Samuel went and dwelt in Naioth.* Now David fled and escaped. He came to Samuel at Ramah and told him all that Saul had done to him. And he and Samuel went and lived at Naioth.
- 19 *And it was told Saul, saying, Behold, David is at Naioth in Ramah.* It was told Saul, "See, David is at Naioth in Ramah."
- 20 *And Saul sent messengers to take David: and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as appointed over them, the Spirit of God was upon the messengers of Saul, and they also prophesied.* Then Saul sent messengers to take David, and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as head over them, the Spirit of God came upon the messengers of Saul. They also prophesied.
- 21 *And when it was told Saul, he sent other messengers, and they prophesied likewise. And Saul sent messengers again the third time, and they prophesied also.* When it was told Saul, he sent other messengers. They also prophesied. And Saul sent messengers again the third time. They also prophesied.
- 22 *Then went he also to Ramah, and came to a great well that is in Sechu: and he asked and said, Where are Samuel and David? And one said, Behold, they be at Naioth in Ramah.* Then he himself went to Ramah and came to the great well that is in Secu. And he asked, "Where are Samuel and David?" And one said, "See, they are at Naioth in Ramah."
- 23 *And he went thither to Naioth in Ramah: and the Spirit of God was upon him also, and he went on, and prophesied, until he came to Naioth in Ramah.* He went there to Naioth in Ramah. And the Spirit of God came upon Him also, and as He went He prophesied until He came to Naioth in Ramah.
- 24 *And he stripped off his clothes also, and prophesied before Samuel in like manner, and lay down naked all that day and all that night. Wherefore they say, Is Saul also among the prophets?* He too stripped off his robes. He too prophesied before Samuel and lay naked all that day and all that night. Thus it is said, "Is Saul also among the prophets?"

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

v4 — Jer 18:20; Prov 31:8-9; Gen 42:22; 1 Sam 20:32; Prov 17:13

v5 — 1 Sam 11:13; 1 Chr 11:14; Judg 9:17; 1 Sam 20:32; Matt 27:4

v6 — Prov 26:24-25

v7 — 1 Sam 16:21; 1 Sam 18:13; 1 Sam 18:2

v9 — 1 Sam 16:14

v11 — Ps 59:1-17

v12 — Josh 2:15

v20 — Joel 2:28; 1 Sam 10:5-6; John 7:32

v23 — Prov 16:9

v24 — 2 Sam 6:20; 1 Sam 10:10-12; Mic 1:8; Isa 20:2

Chapter 20

David and Jonathan devised a plan to test Saul's intentions at the new moon feast. When Saul's murderous rage was confirmed, Jonathan warned David with the prearranged arrow signal, and the two friends parted in tears.

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| <p>¹ <i>And David fled from Naioth in Ramah, and came and said before Jonathan, What have I done? what is mine iniquity? and what is my sin before thy father, that he seeketh my life?</i></p> | <p>Then David fled from Naioth in Ramah and came and said before Jonathan, "What have I done? What is my guilt? And what is my sin before your father, that he seeks my life?"</p> |
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- 2 *And he said unto him, God forbid; thou shalt not die: behold, my father will do nothing either great or small, but that he will shew it me: and why should my father hide this thing from me? it is not so.* He said to him, "Far from it! You shall not die. See, my father does nothing either great or small without disclosing it to me. And why should my father hide this from me? It is not so."
- 3 *And David sware moreover, and said, Thy father certainly knoweth that I have found grace in thine eyes; and he saith, Let not Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved: but truly as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, there is but a step between me and death.* But David vowed again, saying, "Your father knows well that I have found favor in Your eyes. He thinks, 'Do not let Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved.' But truly, as the LORD lives and as Your soul lives, there is but a step between me and death."
- 4 *Then said Jonathan unto David, Whatsoever thy soul desireth, I will even do it for thee.* Then Jonathan said to David, "Whatever you say, I will do for you."
- 5 *And David said unto Jonathan, Behold, to morrow is the new moon, and I should not fail to sit with the king at meat: but let me go, that I may hide myself in the field unto the third day at even.* David said to Jonathan, "See, tomorrow is the new moon. I should not fail to sit at table with the king. But let me go, that I may hide myself in the field till the third day at evening."
- 6 *If thy father at all miss me, then say, David earnestly asked leave of me that he might run to Bethlehem his city: for there is a yearly sacrifice there for all the family.* If your father misses me at all, then say, 'David earnestly asked leave of me to run to Bethlehem his city, for there is a yearly sacrifice there for all the clan.'
- 7 *If he say thus, It is well; thy servant shall have peace: but if he be very wroth, then be sure that evil is determined by him.* If he says, 'Good!' it will be well with your servant, but if he is angry, then know that harm is determined by him.

- 8 *Therefore thou shalt deal kindly with thy servant; for thou hast brought thy servant into a covenant of the LORD with thee: notwithstanding, if there be in me iniquity, slay thou me; for why shouldst thou bring me to thy father?* Therefore deal kindly with Your servant, for You have brought Your servant into a covenant of the LORD with You. But if there is guilt in me, kill me Yourself, for why should You bring me to Your father?"
- 9 *And Jonathan said, Far be it from thee: for if I knew certainly that evil were determined by my father to come upon thee, then would not I tell it thee?* Jonathan said, "Far be it from you! If I knew that it was determined by my father that harm should come to you, would I not tell you?"
- 10 *Then said David to Jonathan, Who shall tell me? or what if thy father answer thee roughly?* Then David said to Jonathan, "Who will tell me if your father answers you harshly?"
- 11 *And Jonathan said unto David, Come, and let us go out into the field. And they went out both of them into the field.* Jonathan said to David, "Come, let us go out into the field." So they both went out into the field.
- 12 *And Jonathan said unto David, O LORD God of Israel, when I have sounded my father about to morrow any time, or the third day, and, behold, if there be good toward David, and I then send not unto thee, and shew it thee;* Jonathan said to David, "The LORD, the God of Israel, be witness! When I have sounded out my father, about this time tomorrow, or the third day, if He is well disposed toward David, shall I not then send and disclose it to you?"
- 13 *The LORD do so and much more to Jonathan: but if it please my father to do thee evil, then I will shew it thee, and send thee away, that thou mayest go in peace: and the LORD be with thee, as he hath been with my father.* But should it please my father to do You harm, the LORD do so to Jonathan and more also if I do not disclose it to you and send You away, that You may go in safety. May the LORD be with You, as He has been with my father.
- 14 *And thou shalt not only while yet I live shew me the kindness of the LORD, that I die not:* If I am still alive, show me the mercy of the LORD, that I may not die;

- 15 *But also thou shalt not cut off thy kindness from my house for ever: no, not when the LORD hath cut off the enemies of David every one from the face of the earth.* Do not cut off Your mercy from my house forever, when the LORD cuts off every one of the enemies of David from the face of the earth."
- 16 *So Jonathan made a covenant with the house of David, saying, Let the LORD even require it at the hand of David's enemies.* Jonathan made a covenant with the house of David, saying, "May the LORD take vengeance on David's enemies."
- 17 *And Jonathan caused David to swear again, because he loved him: for he loved him as he loved his own soul.* Jonathan made David swear again by his love for him, for he loved him as he loved his own soul.
- 18 *Then Jonathan said to David, To morrow is the new moon: and thou shalt be missed, because thy seat will be empty.* Then Jonathan said to him, "Tomorrow is the new moon, and you will be missed, because your seat will be empty."
- 19 *And when thou hast stayed three days, then thou shalt go down quickly, and come to the place where thou didst hide thyself when the business was in hand, and shalt remain by the stone Ezel.* On the third day go down quickly to the place where you hid yourself on that day of trouble, and remain beside the stone Ezel.
- 20 *And I will shoot three arrows on the side thereof, as though I shot at a mark.* I will shoot three arrows to the side of it, as though I were shooting at a mark.
- 21 *And, behold, I will send a lad, saying, Go, find out the arrows. If I expressly say unto the lad, Behold, the arrows are on this side of thee, take them; then come thou: for there is peace to thee, and no hurt; as the LORD liveth.* I will send the boy and say, 'Go, find the arrows.' If I say to the boy, 'Look, the arrows are on this side of you, take them,' then You are to come, for, as the LORD lives, it is safe for You and there is no danger.
- 22 *But if I say thus unto the young man, Behold, the arrows are beyond thee; go thy way: for the LORD hath sent thee away.* But if I say to the boy, 'Look, the arrows are beyond you,' then go, for the LORD has sent You away.

- 23 *And as touching the matter which thou and I have spoken of, behold, the LORD be between thee and me for ever.* As for the matter of which You and I have spoken, the LORD is between You and me forever."
- 24 *So David hid himself in the field: and when the new moon was come, the king sat him down to eat meat.* So David hid himself in the field. And when the new moon came, the king sat down to eat food.
- 25 *And the king sat upon his seat, as at other times, even upon a seat by the wall: and Jonathan arose, and Abner sat by Saul's side, and David's place was empty.* The king sat on his seat, as at other times, on the seat by the wall. Jonathan sat opposite, and Abner sat by Saul's side, but David's place was empty.
- 26 *Nevertheless Saul spake not any thing that day: for he thought, Something hath befallen him, he is not clean; surely he is not clean.* Yet Saul did not say anything that day, for he thought, "Something has happened to him. He is not clean; surely he is not clean."
- 27 *And it came to pass on the morrow, which was the second day of the month, that David's place was empty: and Saul said unto Jonathan his son, Wherefore cometh not the son of Jesse to meat, neither yesterday, nor to day?* But on the second day, the day after the new moon, David's place was empty. And Saul said to Jonathan his son, "Why has the son of Jesse not come to the meal, either yesterday or today?"
- 28 *And Jonathan answered Saul, David earnestly asked leave of me to go to Bethlehem:* Jonathan answered Saul, "David earnestly asked leave of me to go to Bethlehem.
- 29 *And he said, Let me go, I pray thee; for our family hath a sacrifice in the city; and my brother, he hath commanded me to be there: and now, if I have found favour in thine eyes, let me get away, I pray thee, and see my brethren. Therefore he cometh not unto the king's table.* He said, 'Let me go, for our clan holds a sacrifice in the city, and my brother has commanded me to be there. So now, if I have found favor in your eyes, let me get away and see my brothers.' For this reason he has not come to the king's table."

- 30 *Then Saul's anger was kindled against Jonathan, and he said unto him, Thou son of the perverse rebellious woman, do not I know that thou hast chosen the son of Jesse to thine own confusion, and unto the confusion of thy mother's nakedness?* Then Saul's anger was kindled against Jonathan. He said to him, "You son of a perverse, rebellious woman! Do I not know that you have chosen the son of Jesse to your own shame, and to the shame of your mother's nakedness?"
- 31 *For as long as the son of Jesse liveth upon the ground, thou shalt not be established, nor thy kingdom. Wherefore now send and fetch him unto me, for he shall surely die.* For as long as the son of Jesse lives on the earth, neither you nor your kingdom shall be established. Therefore send and bring him to me, for he shall surely die."
- 32 *And Jonathan answered Saul his father, and said unto him, Wherefore shall he be slain? what hath he done?* Then Jonathan answered Saul his father, "Why should he be put to death? What has he done?"
- 33 *And Saul cast a javelin at him to smite him: whereby Jonathan knew that it was determined of his father to slay David.* But Saul hurled his spear at him to strike him. So Jonathan knew that his father was determined to put David to death.
- 34 *So Jonathan arose from the table in fierce anger, and did eat no meat the second day of the month: for he was grieved for David, because his father had done him shame.* Jonathan rose from the table in fierce anger and ate no food the second day of the month, for he was grieved for David, because his father had disgraced him.
- 35 *And it came to pass in the morning, that Jonathan went out into the field at the time appointed with David, and a little lad with him.* In the morning Jonathan went out into the field to the appointment with David, and with him a little boy.
- 36 *And he said unto his lad, Run, find out now the arrows which I shoot. And as the lad ran, he shot an arrow beyond him.* He said to his boy, "Run and find the arrows that I shoot." As the boy ran, he shot an arrow beyond him.

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| <p>37 <i>And when the lad was come to the place of the arrow which Jonathan had shot, Jonathan cried after the lad, and said, Is not the arrow beyond thee?</i></p> <p>38 <i>And Jonathan cried after the lad, Make speed, haste, stay not. And Jonathan's lad gathered up the arrows, and came to his master.</i></p> <p>39 <i>But the lad knew not any thing: only Jonathan and David knew the matter.</i></p> <p>40 <i>And Jonathan gave his artillery unto his lad, and said unto him, Go, carry them to the city.</i></p> <p>41 <i>And as soon as the lad was gone, David arose out of a place toward the south, and fell on his face to the ground, and bowed himself three times: and they kissed one another, and wept one with another, until David exceeded.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And Jonathan said to David, Go in peace, forasmuch as we have sworn both of us in the name of the LORD, saying, The LORD be between me and thee, and between my seed and thy seed for ever. And he arose and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.</i></p> | <p>When the boy came to the place of the arrow that Jonathan had shot, Jonathan called after the boy and said, "Is not the arrow beyond you?"</p> <p>Jonathan called after the boy, "Hurry! Be quick! Do not stop!" So Jonathan's boy gathered up the arrows and came to his master.</p> <p>But the boy knew nothing. Only Jonathan and David knew the matter.</p> <p>Jonathan gave his weapons to his boy and said to him, "Go and carry them to the city."</p> <p>As soon as the boy had gone, David rose from a place toward the south and fell on his face to the ground and bowed three times. And they kissed one another and wept with one another, David weeping the most.</p> <p>Then Jonathan said to David, "Go in peace, because we have sworn both of us in the name of the LORD, saying, 'The LORD shall be between me and You, and between my seed and Your seed, forever.' " And He rose and departed, and Jonathan went into the city.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Num 10:10; 1 Sam 19:2; Num 28:11
v8 — 2 Sam 14:32; 1 Sam 18:3
v13 — 1 Chr 22:16; 1 Sam 17:37; 1 Chr 22:11; Josh 1:5; Ruth 1:17
v14 — 2 Sam 9:3
v16 — 1 Sam 25:22
v17 — Prov 18:24
v23 — 1 Sam 20:14-15; 1 Sam 20:42
v32 — Matt 27:23
v42 — 1 Sam 1:17

Chapter 21

David fled to Nob and received the showbread and the sword of Goliath from Ahimelech the priest. He then went to Achish king of Gath but feared for his life and pretended to be insane.

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| 1 <i>Then came David to Nob to Ahimelech the priest: and Ahimelech was afraid at the meeting of David, and said unto him, Why art thou alone, and no man with thee?</i> | Then David came to Nob, to Ahimelech the priest. And Ahimelech came to meet David trembling and said to him, "Why are you alone, and no one with you?" |
| 2 <i>And David said unto Ahimelech the priest, The king hath commanded me a business, and hath said unto me, Let no man know any thing of the business whereabout I send thee, and what I have commanded thee: and I have appointed my servants to such and such a place.</i> | David said to Ahimelech the priest, "The king has charged me with a matter and said to me, 'Let no one know anything of the matter about which I send you, and with which I have charged you.' I have made an appointment with the young men for such and such a place. |
| 3 <i>Now therefore what is under thine hand? give me five loaves of bread in mine hand, or what there is present.</i> | Now then, what do you have on hand? Give me five loaves of bread, or whatever is here." |
| 4 <i>And the priest answered David, and said, There is no common bread under mine hand, but there is hallowed bread; if the young men have kept themselves at least from women.</i> | The priest answered David, "I have no common bread on hand, but there is holy bread—if the young men have kept themselves from women." |

- 5 *And David answered the priest, and said unto him, Of a truth women have been kept from us about these three days, since I came out, and the vessels of the young men are holy, and the bread is in a manner common, yea, though it were sanctified this day in the vessel.* David answered the priest, "Truly women have been kept from us as always when I go on an expedition. The vessels of the young men are holy even when it is an ordinary journey. How much more today will their vessels be holy?"
- 6 *So the priest gave him hallowed bread: for there was no bread there but the shewbread, that was taken from before the LORD, to put hot bread in the day when it was taken away.* So the priest gave him the holy bread, for there was no bread there but the bread of the Presence, which is removed from before the LORD, to be replaced by hot bread on the day it is taken away.
- 7 *Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, detained before the LORD; and his name was Doeg, an Edomite, the chiefest of the herdmen that belonged to Saul.* Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, detained before the LORD. His name was Doeg the Edomite, the chief of Saul's herdsmen.
- 8 *And David said unto Ahimelech, And is there not here under thine hand spear or sword? for I have neither brought my sword nor my weapons with me, because the king's business required haste.* David said to Ahimelech, "Then do you not have a spear or a sword at hand? For I have brought neither my sword nor my weapons with me, because the king's business required haste."
- 9 *And the priest said, The sword of Goliath the Philistine, whom thou slewest in the valley of Elah, behold, it is here wrapped in a cloth behind the ephod: if thou wilt take that, take it: for there is no other save that here. And David said, There is none like that; give it me.* The priest said, "The sword of Goliath the Philistine, whom you struck down in the Valley of Elah, there it is, wrapped in a cloth behind the ephod. If you will take that, take it, for there is none but that here." And David said, "There is none like that; give it to me."

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| 10 | <i>And David arose, and fled that day for fear of Saul, and went to Achish the king of Gath.</i> | David rose and fled that day from Saul and went to Achish the king of Gath. |
| 11 | <i>And the servants of Achish said unto him, Is not this David the king of the land? did they not sing one to another of him in dances, saying, Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands?</i> | The servants of Achish said to him, "Is not this David the king of the land? Did they not sing to one another of him in dances, 'Saul has struck down his thousands, and David his ten thousands'?" |
| 12 | <i>And David laid up these words in his heart, and was sore afraid of Achish the king of Gath.</i> | David took these words to heart and was very much afraid of Achish the king of Gath. |
| 13 | <i>And he changed his behaviour before them, and feigned himself mad in their hands, and scrabbled on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down upon his beard.</i> | So he changed his behavior before them and pretended to be insane in their hands and made marks on the doors of the gate and let his spittle run down his beard. |
| 14 | <i>Then said Achish unto his servants, Lo, ye see the man is mad: wherefore then have ye brought him to me?</i> | Then Achish said to his servants, "See, the man is mad. Why then have you brought him to me?" |
| 15 | <i>Have I need of mad men, that ye have brought this fellow to play the mad man in my presence? shall this fellow come into my house?</i> | Do I lack madmen, that you have brought this fellow to behave as a madman in my presence? Shall this fellow come into my house?" |

Words in this chapter:

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Neh 11:32; Mark 2:26; Isa 10:32; 1 Sam 14:3; 1 Sam 16:4
- v4 — Matt 12:3-4; Ex 19:15; Ex 25:30
- v6 — Luke 6:3-4; Lev 24:5-9; Matt 12:3-4; Mark 2:25-27
- v7 — 1 Sam 22:9
- v9 — 1 Sam 17:2

v11 — 1 Sam 29:5

v13 — Prov 29:25

Chapter 22

David gathered a band of outcasts at the cave of Adullam. Saul accused his servants of conspiracy and ordered Doeg the Edomite to kill the priests of Nob; eighty-five priests were slaughtered, and only Abiathar escaped to David.

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| <p>1 <i>David therefore departed thence, and escaped to the cave Adullam: and when his brethren and all his father's house heard it, they went down thither to him.</i></p> | <p>David departed from there and escaped to the cave of Adullam. And when his brothers and all his father's house heard it, they went down there to him.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And every one that was in distress, and every one that was in debt, and every one that was discontented, gathered themselves unto him; and he became a captain over them: and there were with him about four hundred men.</i></p> | <p>Everyone who was in distress, and everyone who was in debt, and everyone who was bitter in soul, gathered to him. And he became commander over them. And there were with him about four hundred men.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And David went thence to Mizpeh of Moab: and he said unto the king of Moab, Let my father and my mother, I pray thee, come forth, and be with you, till I know what God will do for me.</i></p> | <p>David went from there to Mizpeh of Moab. And he said to the king of Moab, "Please let my father and my mother stay with you, until I know what God will do for me."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And he brought them before the king of Moab: and they dwelt with him all the while that David was in the hold.</i></p> | <p>He left them with the king of Moab. They stayed with him all the time that David was in the stronghold.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the prophet Gad said unto David, Abide not in the hold; depart, and get thee into the land of Judah. Then David departed, and came into the forest of Hareth.</i></p> | <p>Then the prophet Gad said to David, "Do not remain in the stronghold; depart, and go into the land of Judah." So David departed and went into the forest of Hereth.</p> |

- 6 *When Saul heard that David was discovered, and the men that were with him, (now Saul abode in Gibeah under a tree in Ramah, having his spear in his hand, and all his servants were standing about him;)* Now Saul heard that David was discovered, and the men who were with him. Saul was sitting at Gibeah, under the tamarisk tree on the height, with his spear in his hand. All his servants were standing about him.
- 7 *Then Saul said unto his servants that stood about him, Hear now, ye Benjamites; will the son of Jesse give every one of you fields and vineyards, and make you all captains of thousands, and captains of hundreds;* Saul said to his servants who stood about him, "Hear now, people of Benjamin; will the son of Jesse give every one of you fields and vineyards, will he make you all commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds,
- 8 *That all of you have conspired against me, and there is none that sheweth me that my son hath made a league with the son of Jesse, and there is none of you that is sorry for me, or sheweth unto me that my son hath stirred up my servant against me, to lie in wait, as at this day?* That all of you have conspired against me? No one discloses to me when my son makes a covenant with the son of Jesse. None of you is sorry for me or discloses to me that my son has stirred up my servant against me, to lie in ambush, as at this day."
- 9 *Then answered Doeg the Edomite, which was set over the servants of Saul, and said, I saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to Ahimelech the son of Ahitub.* Then answered Doeg the Edomite, who stood by the servants of Saul, "I saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to Ahimelech the son of Ahitub,
- 10 *And he enquired of the LORD for him, and gave him victuals, and gave him the sword of Goliath the Philistine.* He inquired of the LORD for Him and gave Him provisions and gave Him the sword of Goliath the Philistine."
- 11 *Then the king sent to call Ahimelech the priest, the son of Ahitub, and all his father's house, the priests that were in Nob: and they came all of them to the king.* Then the king sent to summon Ahimelech the priest, the son of Ahitub. All his father's house, the priests who were at Nob. All of them came to the king.

- 12 *And Saul said, Hear now, thou son of Ahitub. And he answered, Here I am, my lord.* Saul said, "Hear now, son of Ahitub." And he answered, "Here I am, my lord."
- 13 *And Saul said unto him, Why have ye conspired against me, thou and the son of Jesse, in that thou hast given him bread, and a sword, and hast enquired of God for him, that he should rise against me, to lie in wait, as at this day?* Saul said to him, "Why have you conspired against me, you and the son of Jesse, in that you have given him bread and a sword and have inquired of God for Him, so that He has risen against me, to lie in ambush, as at this day?"
- 14 *Then Ahimelech answered the king, and said, And who is so faithful among all thy servants as David, which is the king's son in law, and goeth at thy bidding, and is honourable in thine house?* Then Ahimelech answered the king, "And who among all your servants is so faithful as David, who is the king's son-in-law, and goes at your bidding, and is honored in your house?"
- 15 *Did I then begin to enquire of God for him? be it far from me: let not the king impute any thing unto his servant, nor to all the house of my father: for thy servant knew nothing of all this, less or more.* Is today the first time that I have inquired of God for Him? Far be it from me! Let not the king impute anything to his servant or to all the house of my father, for your servant has known nothing of all this, much or little."
- 16 *And the king said, Thou shalt surely die, Ahimelech, thou, and all thy father's house.* The king said, "You shall surely die, Ahimelech, you and all your father's house."
- 17 *And the king said unto the footmen that stood about him, Turn, and slay the priests of the LORD; because their hand also is with David, and because they knew when he fled, and did not shew it to me. But the servants of the king would not put forth their hand to fall upon the priests of the LORD.* The king said to the guard who stood about him, "Turn and kill the priests of the LORD, because their hand also is with David. They knew that he fled and did not disclose it to me." But the servants of the king would not put out their hand to strike the priests of the LORD.

- 18 *And the king said to Doeg, Turn thou, and fall upon the priests. And Doeg the Edomite turned, and he fell upon the priests, and slew on that day fourscore and five persons that did wear a linen ephod.* Then the king said to Doeg, "You turn and strike the priests." And Doeg the Edomite turned and struck the priests. He killed on that day eighty-five men who wore the linen ephod.
- 19 *And Nob, the city of the priests, smote he with the edge of the sword, both men and women, children and sucklings, and oxen, and asses, and sheep, with the edge of the sword.* Nob, the city of the priests, he struck with the edge of the sword, both man and woman, child and infant, ox, donkey and sheep, with the edge of the sword.
- 20 *And one of the sons of Ahimelech the son of Ahitub, named Abiathar, escaped, and fled after David.* But one of the sons of Ahimelech the son of Ahitub, named Abiathar, escaped and fled after David.
- 21 *And Abiathar shewed David that Saul had slain the LORD'S priests.* Abiathar told David that Saul had killed the priests of the LORD.
- 22 *And David said unto Abiathar, I knew it that day, when Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell Saul: I have occasioned the death of all the persons of thy father's house.* David said to Abiathar, "I knew on that day, when Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell Saul. I have caused the death of all the persons of your father's house.
- 23 *Abide thou with me, fear not: for he that seeketh my life seeketh thy life: but with me thou shalt be in safeguard.* Stay with me; do not be afraid, for he who seeks my life seeks your life. With me you shall be safe."

Words in this chapter:

victuals (VIT-ulz) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 57:1-11

v2 — Matt 11:28; Ps 72:12-14; 1 Sam 1:10; 1 Sam 30:6; 1 Sam 25:13

v10 — Num 27:21

v13 — 1 Sam 22:8

v17 — Ex 1:17

v19 — 1 Sam 15:3

v20 — 1 Sam 23:6; 1 Sam 30:7

v23 — 1 Kgs 2:26; John 10:28-30; Heb 12:1-3; John 18:9

Chapter 23

David rescued the city of Keilah from the Philistines, but fled when God warned that the men of Keilah would surrender him to Saul. Saul pursued David in the wilderness of Ziph, but Jonathan came and strengthened David's hand in God.

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| <p>1 <i>Then they told David, saying, Behold, the Philistines fight against Keilah, and they rob the threshingfloors.</i></p> | Now they told David, "See, the Philistines are fighting against Keilah and are robbing the threshing floors." |
| <p>2 <i>Therefore David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go and smite these Philistines? And the LORD said unto David, Go, and smite the Philistines, and save Keilah.</i></p> | Therefore David inquired of the LORD, "Shall I go and attack these Philistines?" And the LORD said to David, "Go and attack the Philistines and save Keilah." |
| <p>3 <i>And David's men said unto him, Behold, we be afraid here in Judah: how much more then if we come to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines?</i></p> | But David's men said to him, "See, we are afraid here in Judah. How much more then if we go to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines?" |
| <p>4 <i>Then David enquired of the LORD yet again. And the LORD answered him and said, Arise, go down to Keilah; for I will deliver the Philistines into thine hand.</i></p> | Then David inquired of the LORD again. And the LORD answered Him, "Arise, go down to Keilah, for I will give the Philistines into Your hand." |
| <p>5 <i>So David and his men went to Keilah, and fought with the Philistines, and brought away their cattle, and smote them with a great slaughter. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah.</i></p> | David and his men went to Keilah and fought with the Philistines and brought away their livestock and struck them with a great blow. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah. |
| <p>6 <i>And it came to pass, when Abiathar the son of Ahimelech fled to David to Keilah, that he came down with an ephod in his hand.</i></p> | When Abiathar the son of Ahimelech had fled to David to Keilah, he had come down with an ephod in his hand. |

- 7 *And it was told Saul that David was come to Keilah. And Saul said, God hath delivered him into mine hand; for he is shut in, by entering into a town that hath gates and bars.* Now it was told Saul that David had come to Keilah. And Saul said, "God has given Him into my hand, for He has shut himself in by entering a town that has gates and bars."
- 8 *And Saul called all the people together to war, to go down to Keilah, to besiege David and his men.* Saul summoned all the people to war, to go down to Keilah, to besiege David and his men.
- 9 *And David knew that Saul secretly practised mischief against him; and he said to Abiathar the priest, Bring hither the ephod.* David knew that Saul was plotting harm against him. And he said to Abiathar the priest, "Bring the ephod here."
- 10 *Then said David, O LORD God of Israel, thy servant hath certainly heard that Saul seeketh to come to Keilah, to destroy the city for my sake.* Then David said, "O LORD, the God of Israel, Your servant has surely heard that Saul seeks to come to Keilah, to destroy the city on my account.
- 11 *Will the men of Keilah deliver me up into his hand? will Saul come down, as thy servant hath heard? O LORD God of Israel, I beseech thee, tell thy servant. And the LORD said, He will come down.* Will the men of Keilah surrender me into His hand? Will Saul come down, as your servant has heard? O LORD, the God of Israel, please tell Your servant." And the LORD said, "He will come down."
- 12 *Then said David, Will the men of Keilah deliver me and my men into the hand of Saul? And the LORD said, They will deliver thee up.* Then David said, "Will the men of Keilah surrender me and my men into the hand of Saul?" And the LORD said, "They will surrender You."
- 13 *Then David and his men, which were about six hundred, arose and departed out of Keilah, and went whithersoever they could go. And it was told Saul that David was escaped from Keilah; and he forbore to go forth.* Then David and his men, who were about six hundred, arose and departed from Keilah. They went wherever they could go. When Saul was told that David had escaped from Keilah, he gave up the expedition.

- 14 *And David abode in the wilderness in strong holds, and remained in a mountain in the wilderness of Ziph. And Saul sought him every day, but God delivered him not into his hand.* David remained in the strongholds in the wilderness, in the hill country in the wilderness of Ziph. And Saul sought him every day. But God did not give Him into His hand.
- 15 *And David saw that Saul was come out to seek his life: and David was in the wilderness of Ziph in a wood.* David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life. David was in the wilderness of Ziph in a wood.
- 16 *And Jonathan Saul's son arose, and went to David into the wood, and strengthened his hand in God.* Jonathan, Saul's son, rose and went to David into the wood, and strengthened his hand in God.
- 17 *And he said unto him, Fear not: for the hand of Saul my father shall not find thee; and thou shalt be king over Israel, and I shall be next unto thee; and that also Saul my father knoweth.* He said to him, "Do not be afraid, for the hand of Saul my father shall not find you. You shall be king over Israel. I shall be next to you. Saul my father also knows this."
- 18 *And they two made a covenant before the LORD: and David abode in the wood, and Jonathan went to his house.* The two of them made a covenant before the LORD. David remained in the wood, and Jonathan went home.
- 19 *Then came up the Ziphites to Saul at Gibeah, saying, Doth not David hide himself with us in strong holds in the wood, in the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of Jeshimon?* Then the Ziphites went up to Saul at Gibeah, saying, "Is not David hiding among us in the strongholds in the wood, on the hill of Hachilah, which is south of Jeshimon?"
- 20 *Now therefore, O king, come down according to all the desire of thy soul to come down; and our part shall be to deliver him into the king's hand.* Now come down, O king, according to all your heart's desire to come down, and our part shall be to surrender him into the king's hand."
- 21 *And Saul said, Blessed be ye of the LORD; for ye have compassion on me.* Saul said, "May you be blessed by the LORD, for You have had compassion on me."

- 22 *Go, I pray you, prepare yet, and know and see his place where his haunt is, and who hath seen him there: for it is told me that he dealeth very subtilly.* Go, make yet more sure. Know and see the place where His foot is, and who has seen Him there, for it is told me that He is very cunning.
- 23 *See therefore, and take knowledge of all the lurking places where he hideth himself, and come ye again to me with the certainty, and I will go with you: and it shall come to pass, if he be in the land, that I will search him out throughout all the thousands of Judah.* See therefore, and learn all the hiding places where He hides, and come back to me with sure information. Then I will go with You. And if He is in the land, I will search Him out among all the thousands of Judah."
- 24 *And they arose, and went to Ziph before Saul: but David and his men were in the wilderness of Maon, in the plain on the south of Jeshimon.* They arose and went to Ziph ahead of Saul. But David and his men were in the wilderness of Maon, in the plain to the south of Jeshimon.
- 25 *Saul also and his men went to seek him. And they told David: wherefore he came down into a rock, and abode in the wilderness of Maon. And when Saul heard that, he pursued after David in the wilderness of Maon.* Saul and his men went to seek him. And David was told, so he went down to the rock and lived in the wilderness of Maon. And when Saul heard that, he pursued David in the wilderness of Maon.
- 26 *And Saul went on this side of the mountain, and David and his men on that side of the mountain: and David made haste to get away for fear of Saul; for Saul and his men compassed David and his men round about to take them.* Saul went on one side of the mountain, and David and his men on the other side of the mountain. And David was hurrying to get away from Saul. As Saul and his men were closing in on David and his men to capture them,
- 27 *But there came a messenger unto Saul, saying, Haste thee, and come; for the Philistines have invaded the land.* A messenger came to Saul, saying, "Hurry and come, for the Philistines have raided the land."

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| <p>28 <i>Wherefore Saul returned from pursuing after David, and went against the Philistines: therefore they called that place Selahammahlekoth.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And David went up from thence, and dwelt in strong holds at Engedi.</i></p> | <p>So Saul turned back from pursuing David and went against the Philistines. Therefore that place was called Selahammahlekoth.</p> <p>David went up from there and lived in the strongholds of En-gedi.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 15:44
- v2 — 1 Sam 23:4; 2 Sam 5:19; 2 Sam 5:23; 1 Sam 23:6; 1 Sam 23:9-12
- v4 — Judg 7:7
- v6 — 1 Sam 22:20
- v9 — 1 Sam 30:7
- v13 — 1 Sam 22:2; 1 Sam 25:13
- v14 — Ps 54:3-4; Ps 32:7
- v16 — Isa 35:3-4; Heb 12:12-13; Job 4:3-4; 2 Tim 2:1; Eph 6:10
- v17 — 1 Sam 20:31; 1 Sam 24:20
- v18 — 2 Sam 21:7; 1 Sam 18:3; 1 Sam 20:42
- v19 — 1 Sam 26:1
- v24 — Josh 15:55; 1 Sam 25:2

Chapter 24

Saul entered a cave at En-gedi where David was hiding, and David secretly cut off a corner of Saul's robe but refused to kill the LORD's anointed. David showed the cut robe to Saul, and Saul wept, acknowledging that David would be king.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, when Saul was returned from following the Philistines, that it was told him, saying, Behold, David is in the wilderness of Engedi.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Then Saul took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and went to seek David and his men upon the rocks of the wild goats.</i></p> | <p>When Saul returned from following the Philistines, he was told, "See, David is in the wilderness of En-gedi."</p> <p>Then Saul took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel and went to seek David and his men in front of the Rocks of the Wild Goats.</p> |
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- 3 *And he came to the sheepcotes by the way, where was a cave; and Saul went in to cover his feet: and David and his men remained in the sides of the cave.* He came to the sheepfolds beside the road, where there was a cave, and Saul went in to relieve himself. Now David and his men were sitting in the innermost parts of the cave.
- 4 *And the men of David said unto him, Behold the day of which the LORD said unto thee, Behold, I will deliver thine enemy into thine hand, that thou mayest do to him as it shall seem good unto thee. Then David arose, and cut off the skirt of Saul's robe privily.* The men of David said to him, "Here is the day of which the LORD said to You, 'I will give Your enemy into Your hand, and You shall do to Him as it seems good to You.' " Then David arose and stealthily cut off a corner of Saul's robe.
- 5 *And it came to pass afterward, that David's heart smote him, because he had cut off Saul's skirt.* Afterward David's heart struck him, because he had cut off a corner of Saul's robe.
- 6 *And he said unto his men, The LORD forbid that I should do this thing unto my master, the LORD'S anointed, to stretch forth mine hand against him, seeing he is the anointed of the LORD.* He said to His men, "The LORD forbid that I should do this thing to my lord, the LORD's anointed, to put out my hand against Him, seeing He is the LORD's anointed."
- 7 *So David stayed his servants with these words, and suffered them not to rise against Saul. But Saul rose up out of the cave, and went on his way.* So David persuaded his men with these words and did not permit them to attack Saul. And Saul rose up and left the cave and went on his way.
- 8 *David also arose afterward, and went out of the cave, and cried after Saul, saying, My lord the king. And when Saul looked behind him, David stooped with his face to the earth, and bowed himself.* Afterward David also arose and went out of the cave, and called after Saul, "My lord the king!" And when Saul looked behind him, David bowed with his face to the earth and paid homage.
- 9 *And David said to Saul, Wherefore hearest thou men's words, saying, Behold, David seeketh thy hurt?* David said to Saul, "Why do you listen to the words of men who say, 'See, David seeks your harm'?"

- 10 *Behold, this day thine eyes have seen how that the LORD had delivered thee to day into mine hand in the cave: and some bade me kill thee: but mine eye spared thee; and I said, I will not put forth mine hand against my lord; for he is the LORD'S anointed.* See, this day Your eyes have seen how the LORD gave You today into my hand in the cave. And some told me to kill You. But I spared You. I said, 'I will not put out my hand against my lord, for He is the LORD's anointed.'
- 11 *Moreover, my father, see, yea, see the skirt of thy robe in my hand: for in that I cut off the skirt of thy robe, and killed thee not, know thou and see that there is neither evil nor transgression in mine hand, and I have not sinned against thee; yet thou huntest my soul to take it.* See, my father, see the corner of Your robe in my hand. For by the fact that I cut off the corner of Your robe and did not kill You, You may know and see that there is no wrong or treason in my hands. I have not sinned against You, though You hunt my life to take it.
- 12 *The LORD judge between me and thee, and the LORD avenge me of thee: but mine hand shall not be upon thee.* May the LORD judge between me and You, may the LORD avenge me against You, but my hand shall not be against You.
- 13 *As saith the proverb of the ancients, Wickedness proceedeth from the wicked: but mine hand shall not be upon thee.* As the proverb of the ancients says, 'Out of the wicked comes wickedness.' But my hand shall not be against you.
- 14 *After whom is the king of Israel come out? after whom dost thou pursue? after a dead dog, after a flea.* After whom has the king of Israel come out? After whom do you pursue? After a dead dog! After a flea!
- 15 *The LORD therefore be judge, and judge between me and thee, and see, and plead my cause, and deliver me out of thine hand.* May the LORD therefore be judge and give sentence between me and You, and see to it and plead my cause and deliver me from Your hand."
- 16 *And it came to pass, when David had made an end of speaking these words unto Saul, that Saul said, Is this thy voice, my son David? And Saul lifted up his voice, and wept.* As soon as David had finished speaking these words to Saul, Saul said, "Is this your voice, my son David?" And Saul lifted up his voice and wept.

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| <p>17 <i>And he said to David, Thou art more righteous than I: for thou hast rewarded me good, whereas I have rewarded thee evil.</i></p> | <p>He said, "You are more righteous than I, for you have repaid me good, whereas I have repaid you evil.</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And thou hast shewed this day how that thou hast dealt well with me: forasmuch as when the LORD had delivered me into thine hand, thou killedst me not.</i></p> | <p>You have declared this day how You have dealt well with me, in that You did not kill me when the LORD put me into Your hands.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>For if a man find his enemy, will he let him go well away? wherefore the LORD reward thee good for that thou hast done unto me this day.</i></p> | <p>For if a man finds his enemy, will he let him go away safe? So may the LORD reward You with good for what You have done to me this day.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And now, behold, I know well that thou shalt surely be king, and that the kingdom of Israel shall be established in thine hand.</i></p> | <p>Now, see, I know that You shall surely be king, and that the kingdom of Israel shall be established in Your hand.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>Swear now therefore unto me by the LORD, that thou wilt not cut off my seed after me, and that thou wilt not destroy my name out of my father's house.</i></p> | <p>Swear to me therefore by the LORD that You will not cut off my seed after me, and that You will not destroy my name out of my father's house."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And David sware unto Saul. And Saul went home; but David and his men gat them up unto the hold.</i></p> | <p>David swore this to Saul. Then Saul went home, but David and his men went up to the stronghold.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

transgression — Crossing the line God set — deliberately breaking a specific command He gave.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v3** — Judg 3:24
v4 — 1 Sam 26:8-11; 1 Sam 26:23; 1 Sam 24:10; 1 Sam 25:28-30
v5 — 2 Sam 24:10
v6 — 2 Sam 1:14
v10 — 1 Sam 24:4
v11 — 1 Sam 26:20
v12 — Judg 11:27; Ps 43:1; Ps 35:1; Gen 16:5; Job 5:8
v13 — Matt 7:20; Matt 7:16-18
v14 — 1 Sam 26:20
v15 — Ps 43:1; Ps 35:1; Ps 119:154; 1 Sam 24:12
v16 — 1 Sam 26:17
v17 — Matt 5:44; 1 Sam 26:21

Chapter 25

The wealthy fool Nabal refused David's request for provisions, and David set out to destroy him. Nabal's wise wife Abigail intercepted David with gifts and a plea for restraint; ten days later the LORD struck Nabal dead, and David took Abigail as his wife.

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| <p>1 <i>And Samuel died; and all the Israelites were gathered together, and lamented him, and buried him in his house at Ramah. And David arose, and went down to the wilderness of Paran.</i></p> | <p>Now Samuel died. And all Israel assembled and mourned for him. They buried him in his house at Ramah. Then David rose and went down to the wilderness of Paran.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And there was a man in Maon, whose possessions were in Carmel; and the man was very great, and he had three thousand sheep, and a thousand goats: and he was shearing his sheep in Carmel.</i></p> | <p>There was a man in Maon whose business was in Carmel. The man was very rich; he had three thousand sheep and a thousand goats. He was shearing his sheep in Carmel.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now the name of the man was Nabal; and the name of his wife Abigail: and she was a woman of good understanding, and of a beautiful countenance: but the man was churlish and evil in his doings; and he was of the house of Caleb.</i></p> | <p>Now the name of the man was Nabal, and the name of his wife Abigail. The woman was of good understanding and of a beautiful countenance, but the man was harsh and badly behaved. He was a Calebite.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Abigail** (AB-ih-gayl) — "father's joy" — *The wise and beautiful wife of the foolish Nabal. She intercepted David with provisions and a speech of remarkable wisdom, preventing him from bloodshed. After Nabal's death she became David's wife.*

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| 4 | <i>And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal did shear his sheep.</i> | David heard in the wilderness that Nabal was shearing his sheep. |
| 5 | <i>And David sent out ten young men, and David said unto the young men, Get you up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and greet him in my name:</i> | So David sent ten young men. And David said to the young men, "Go up to Carmel, and go to Nabal and greet him in my name. |
| 6 | <i>And thus shall ye say to him that liveth in prosperity, Peace be both to thee, and peace be to thine house, and peace be unto all that thou hast.</i> | Thus you shall greet him: 'Peace be to you, and peace be to your house, and peace be to all that you have. |
| 7 | <i>And now I have heard that thou hast shearers: now thy shepherds which were with us, we touched them not, neither was there ought missing unto them, all the while they were in Carmel.</i> | I hear that you have shearers. Now your shepherds have been with us. We did not harm them. They missed nothing all the time they were in Carmel. |
| 8 | <i>Ask thy young men, and they will shew thee. Wherefore let the young men find favour in thine eyes: for we come in a good day: give, I pray thee, whatsoever cometh to thine hand unto thy servants, and to thy son David.</i> | Ask your young men. They will tell you. Therefore let my young men find favor in your eyes, for we come on a good day. Please give whatever you have at hand to your servants and to your son David.' " |
| 9 | <i>And when David's young men came, they spake to Nabal according to all those words in the name of David, and ceased.</i> | When David's young men came, they said all this to Nabal in the name of David, and then they waited. |
| 10 | <i>And Nabal answered David's servants, and said, Who is David? and who is the son of Jesse? there be many servants now a days that break away every man from his master.</i> | Nabal answered David's servants, "Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants these days who are breaking away from their masters. |

- 11 *Shall I then take my bread, and my water, and my flesh that I have killed for my shearers, and give it unto men, whom I know not whence they be?* Shall I take my bread and my water and my meat that I have killed for my shearers and give it to men who come from I do not know where?"
- 12 *So David's young men turned their way, and went again, and came and told him all those sayings.* So David's young men turned away and came back and told him all this.
- 13 *And David said unto his men, Gird ye on every man his sword. And they girded on every man his sword; and David also girded on his sword: and there went up after David about four hundred men; and two hundred abode by the stuff.* David said to his men, "Every man strap on his sword!" And every man strapped on his sword. David also strapped on his sword. And about four hundred men went up after David, while two hundred remained with the baggage.
- 14 *But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal's wife, saying, Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to salute our master; and he railed on them.* But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal's wife, "See, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to greet our master. He shouted at them.
- 15 *But the men were very good unto us, and we were not hurt, neither missed we any thing, as long as we were conversant with them, when we were in the fields:* Yet the men were very good to us. We suffered no harm. We did not miss anything when we were in the fields, as long as we went with them.
- 16 *They were a wall unto us both by night and day, all the while we were with them keeping the sheep.* They were a wall to us both by night and by day, all the while we were with them keeping the sheep.
- 17 *Now therefore know and consider what thou wilt do; for evil is determined against our master, and against all his household: for he is such a son of Belial, that a man cannot speak to him.* Now therefore know this and consider what you should do, for harm is determined against our master and against all his house. He is such a worthless man that one cannot speak to him."

- 18 *Then Abigail made haste, and took two hundred loaves, and two bottles of wine, and five sheep ready dressed, and five measures of parched corn, and an hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on asses.* Then Abigail made haste and took two hundred loaves and two skins of wine and five sheep already prepared and five seahs of parched grain and a hundred clusters of raisins and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys.
- 19 *And she said unto her servants, Go on before me; behold, I come after you. But she told not her husband Nabal.* She said to her young men, "Go on before me; see, I come after you." But she did not tell her husband Nabal.
- 20 *And it was so, as she rode on the ass, that she came down by the covert of the hill, and, behold, David and his men came down against her; and she met them.* As she rode on the donkey and came down under cover of the mountain, David and his men came down toward her. She met them.
- 21 *Now David had said, Surely in vain have I kept all that this fellow hath in the wilderness, so that nothing was missed of all that pertained unto him: and he hath requited me evil for good.* Now David had said, "Surely it was in vain that I guarded all that this fellow has in the wilderness, so that nothing was missed of all that belonged to him. He has returned me evil for good.
- 22 *So and more also do God unto the enemies of David, if I leave of all that pertain to him by the morning light any that pisseth against the wall.* God do so to the enemies of David and more also, if by morning I leave so much as any that pisseth against the wall of all who belong to him."
- 23 *And when Abigail saw David, she hasted, and lighted off the ass, and fell before David on her face, and bowed herself to the ground,* When Abigail saw David, she hurried and got down from the donkey and fell before David on her face and bowed to the ground.
- 24 *And fell at his feet, and said, Upon me, my lord, upon me let this iniquity be: and let thine handmaid, I pray thee, speak in thine audience, and hear the words of thine handmaid.* She fell at his feet and said, "On me alone, my lord, be the guilt. Please let your servant speak in your ears, and hear the words of your servant.

- 25 *Let not my lord, I pray thee, regard this man of Belial, even Nabal: for as his name is, so is he; Nabal is his name, and folly is with him: but I thine handmaid saw not the young men of my lord, whom thou didst send.* Let not my lord regard this worthless man, Nabal, for as his name is, so is he. Nabal is his name, and folly is with him. But I your servant did not see the young men of my lord, whom you sent.
- 26 *Now therefore, my lord, as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, seeing the LORD hath withholden thee from coming to shed blood, and from avenging thyself with thine own hand, now let thine enemies, and they that seek evil to my lord, be as Nabal.* Now then, my lord, as the LORD lives, and as Your soul lives, because the LORD has restrained You from bloodguilt and from saving Yourself with Your own hand, now then let Your enemies and those who seek to do evil to my lord be as Nabal.
- 27 *And now this blessing which thine handmaid hath brought unto my lord, let it even be given unto the young men that follow my lord.* Now let this present that Your servant has brought to my lord be given to the young men who follow my lord.
- 28 *I pray thee, forgive the trespass of thine handmaid: for the LORD will certainly make my lord a sure house; because my lord fighteth the battles of the LORD, and evil hath not been found in thee all thy days.* Please forgive the trespass of Your servant. For the LORD will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord is fighting the battles of the LORD, and evil shall not be found in You so long as You live.
- 29 *Yet a man is risen to pursue thee, and to seek thy soul: but the soul of my lord shall be bound in the bundle of life with the LORD thy God; and the souls of thine enemies, them shall he sling out, as out of the middle of a sling.* If men rise up to pursue You and to seek Your life, the life of my lord shall be bound in the bundle of the living in the care of the LORD Your God. And the lives of Your enemies He shall sling out as from the hollow of a sling.
- 30 *And it shall come to pass, when the LORD shall have done to my lord according to all the good that he hath spoken concerning thee, and shall have appointed thee ruler over Israel;* When the LORD has done to my lord according to all the good that He has spoken concerning You and has appointed You prince over Israel,

- 31 *That this shall be no grief unto thee, nor offence of heart unto my lord, either that thou hast shed blood causeless, or that my lord hath avenged himself: but when the LORD shall have dealt well with my lord, then remember thine handmaid.* My lord shall have no cause of grief or pangs of conscience for having shed blood without cause or for my lord working salvation Himself. And when the LORD has dealt well with my lord, remember Your servant."
- 32 *And David said to Abigail, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which sent thee this day to meet me:* David said to Abigail, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who sent You this day to meet me!
- 33 *And blessed be thy advice, and blessed be thou, which hast kept me this day from coming to shed blood, and from avenging myself with mine own hand.* Blessed be Your discretion, and blessed be You, who have kept me this day from bloodguilt and from working salvation with my own hand!
- 34 *For in very deed, as the LORD God of Israel liveth, which hath kept me back from hurting thee, except thou hadst hasted and come to meet me, surely there had not been left unto Nabal by the morning light any that pisseth against the wall.* For as surely as the LORD, the God of Israel, lives, who has restrained me from hurting You, unless You had hurried and come to meet me, truly by morning there would not have been left to Nabal so much as any that pisseth against the wall."
- 35 *So David received of her hand that which she had brought him, and said unto her, Go up in peace to thine house; see, I have hearkened to thy voice, and have accepted thy person.* Then David received from her hand what she had brought him. And he said to her, "Go up in peace to your house. See, I have obeyed your voice. I have granted your petition."
- 36 *And Abigail came to Nabal; and, behold, he held a feast in his house, like the feast of a king; and Nabal's heart was merry within him, for he was very drunken: wherefore she told him nothing, less or more, until the morning light.* Abigail came to Nabal, and there he was holding a feast in his house, like the feast of a king. And Nabal's heart was merry within him, for he was very drunk. So she told him nothing at all until the morning light.

- 37 *But it came to pass in the morning, when the wine was gone out of Nabal, and his wife had told him these things, that his heart died within him, and he became as a stone.* In the morning, when the wine had gone out of Nabal, his wife told him these things. His heart died within him. He became like a stone.
- 38 *And it came to pass about ten days after, that the LORD smote Nabal, that he died.* About ten days later the LORD struck Nabal. He died.
- 39 *And when David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, Blessed be the LORD, that hath pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and hath kept his servant from evil: for the LORD hath returned the wickedness of Nabal upon his own head. And David sent and communed with Abigail, to take her to him to wife.* When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, "Blessed be the LORD Who has avenged the insult I received at the hand of Nabal, and has kept back His servant from wrongdoing. The LORD has returned the evil of Nabal on His own head." Then David sent and spoke to Abigail, to take her as his wife.
- 40 *And when the servants of David were come to Abigail to Carmel, they spake unto her, saying, David sent us unto thee, to take thee to him to wife.* When the servants of David came to Abigail at Carmel, they said to her, "David has sent us to you to take you to him as his wife."
- 41 *And she arose, and bowed herself on her face to the earth, and said, Behold, let thine handmaid be a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my lord.* She rose and bowed with her face to the ground and said, "See, your servant is a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my lord."
- 42 *And Abigail hasted, and arose, and rode upon an ass, with five damsels of hers that went after her; and she went after the messengers of David, and became his wife.* Abigail hurried and rose and mounted a donkey. Her five young women attended her. She followed the messengers of David and became his wife.
- 43 *David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they were also both of them his wives.* David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel, and both of them became his wives.

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| 44 <i>But Saul had given Michal his daughter, David's wife, to Phalti the son of Laish, which was of Gallim.</i> | Saul had given Michal his daughter, David's wife, to Palti the son of Laish, who was of Gallim. |
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Words in this chapter:

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 28:3; Deut 34:8; Num 20:29; 2 Chr 33:20
- v2 — 1 Sam 23:24; Gen 38:13; Josh 15:55; Luke 16:19-25
- v3 — Prov 14:1; Prov 31:10; Isa 32:5-7; Ps 10:3; Prov 31:30-31
- v6 — 1 Chr 12:18; Ps 122:7
- v15 — 1 Sam 25:7; 1 Sam 25:21
- v26 — 2 Sam 18:32; Rom 12:19-20; Gen 20:6
- v27 — Gen 33:11; 1 Sam 30:26
- v28 — 1 Sam 18:17; 2 Sam 7:11
- v29 — John 17:21; Matt 10:29-30; Mal 3:17; Ps 116:15; Ps 66:9
- v32 — Luke 1:68; Gen 24:27; Ps 72:18; Ex 18:10
- v41 — 1 Tim 5:10; Ruth 2:10; John 13:3-5
- v43 — 1 Sam 30:5; Josh 15:56; 1 Sam 27:3

Chapter 26

The Ziphites again betrayed David's location to Saul, and David crept into Saul's camp at night, taking his spear and water jug while he slept. David rebuked Abner for failing to guard the king, and Saul again confessed he had sinned.

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| 1 <i>And the Ziphites came unto Saul to Gibeah, saying, Doth not David hide himself in the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon?</i> | Then the Ziphites came to Saul at Gibeah, saying, "Is not David hiding himself on the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon?" |
| 2 <i>Then Saul arose, and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, having three thousand chosen men of Israel with him, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph.</i> | So Saul arose and went down to the wilderness of Ziph with three thousand chosen men of Israel to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph. |

- 3 *And Saul pitched in the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon, by the way. But David abode in the wilderness, and he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness.* Saul encamped on the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon, beside the road. But David remained in the wilderness. When he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness,
- 4 *David therefore sent out spies, and understood that Saul was come in very deed.* David sent out spies and learned that Saul had indeed come.
- 5 *And David arose, and came to the place where Saul had pitched: and David beheld the place where Saul lay, and Abner the son of Ner, the captain of his host: and Saul lay in the trench, and the people pitched round about him.* Then David rose and came to the place where Saul had encamped. And David saw the place where Saul lay, with Abner the son of Ner, the commander of his army. Saul was lying within the encampment, while the army was encamped around him.
- 6 *Then answered David and said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother to Joab, saying, Who will go down with me to Saul to the camp? And Abishai said, I will go down with thee.* Then David said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, "Who will go down with me into the camp to Saul?" And Abishai said, "I will go down with you."
- 7 *So David and Abishai came to the people by night: and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the trench, and his spear stuck in the ground at his bolster: but Abner and the people lay round about him.* So David and Abishai went to the army by night. And there lay Saul sleeping within the encampment, with his spear stuck in the ground at his head, and Abner and the army lay around him.
- 8 *Then said Abishai to David, God hath delivered thine enemy into thine hand this day: now therefore let me smite him, I pray thee, with the spear even to the earth at once, and I will not smite him the second time.* Then Abishai said to David, "God has given your enemy into your hand this day. Now please let me pin Him to the earth with one stroke of the spear. I will not strike Him twice."

- 9 *And David said to Abishai, Destroy him not: for who can stretch forth his hand against the LORD'S anointed, and be guiltless?* But David said to Abishai, "Do not destroy him, for who can put out His hand against the LORD's anointed and be guiltless?"
- 10 *David said furthermore, As the LORD liveth, the LORD shall smite him; or his day shall come to die; or he shall descend into battle, and perish.* David said, "As the LORD lives, the LORD will strike Him, or His day will come to die, or He will go down into battle and perish.
- 11 *The LORD forbid that I should stretch forth mine hand against the LORD'S anointed: but, I pray thee, take thou now the spear that is at his bolster, and the cruse of water, and let us go.* The LORD forbid that I should put out my hand against the LORD's anointed. But take now the spear that is at His head and the jar of water, and let us go."
- 12 *So David took the spear and the cruse of water from Saul's bolster; and they gat them away, and no man saw it, nor knew it, neither awaked: for they were all asleep; because a deep sleep from the LORD was fallen upon them.* So David took the spear and the jar of water from Saul's head. They went away. No man saw it or knew it, nor did any awake, for they were all asleep, because a deep sleep from the LORD had fallen upon them.
- 13 *Then David went over to the other side, and stood on the top of an hill afar off; a great space being between them:* Then David went over to the other side and stood far off on the top of the hill, with a great distance between them.
- 14 *And David cried to the people, and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, Answerest thou not, Abner? Then Abner answered and said, Who art thou that criest to the king?* David called to the army and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, "Will you not answer, Abner?" Then Abner answered, "Who are you who calls to the king?"
- 15 *And David said to Abner, Art not thou a valiant man? and who is like to thee in Israel? wherefore then hast thou not kept thy lord the king? for there came one of the people in to destroy the king thy lord.* David said to Abner, "Are you not a man? Who is your equal in Israel? Why then have you not kept watch over your lord the king? For one of the people came in to destroy the king your lord.

- 16 *This thing is not good that thou hast done. As the LORD liveth, ye are worthy to die, because ye have not kept your master, the LORD'S anointed. And now see where the king's spear is, and the cruse of water that was at his bolster.* This thing that You have done is not good. As the LORD lives, You deserve to die, because You have not kept watch over Your lord, the LORD's anointed. And now see where the king's spear is and the jar of water that was at His head."
- 17 *And Saul knew David's voice, and said, Is this thy voice, my son David? And David said, It is my voice, my lord, O king.* Saul recognized David's voice and said, "Is this your voice, my son David?" And David said, "It is my voice, my lord, O king."
- 18 *And he said, Wherefore doth my lord thus pursue after his servant? for what have I done? or what evil is in mine hand?* He said, "Why does my lord pursue after his servant? For what have I done? What evil is on my hands?"
- 19 *Now therefore, I pray thee, let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If the LORD have stirred thee up against me, let him accept an offering: but if they be the children of men, cursed be they before the LORD; for they have driven me out this day from abiding in the inheritance of the LORD, saying, Go, serve other gods.* Now therefore let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If it is the LORD Who has stirred You up against me, may He accept an offering, but if it is men, may they be cursed before the LORD, for they have driven me out this day that I should have no share in the heritage of the LORD, saying, 'Go, serve other gods.'
- 20 *Now therefore, let not my blood fall to the earth before the face of the LORD: for the king of Israel is come out to seek a flea, as when one doth hunt a partridge in the mountains.* Now therefore, do not let my blood fall to the earth away from the presence of the LORD, for the king of Israel has come out to seek a single flea like one who hunts a partridge in the mountains."

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| <p>21 <i>Then said Saul, I have sinned: return, my son David: for I will no more do thee harm, because my soul was precious in thine eyes this day: behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And David answered and said, Behold the king's spear! and let one of the young men come over and fetch it.</i></p> <p>23 <i>The LORD render to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness: for the LORD delivered thee into my hand to day, but I would not stretch forth mine hand against the LORD'S anointed.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And, behold, as thy life was much set by this day in mine eyes, so let my life be much set by in the eyes of the LORD, and let him deliver me out of all tribulation.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Then Saul said to David, Blessed be thou, my son David: thou shalt both do great things, and also shalt still prevail. So David went on his way, and Saul returned to his place.</i></p> | <p>Then Saul said, "I have sinned. Return, my son David, for I will no more do you harm, because my life was precious in your eyes this day. See, I have acted foolishly, and have made a great mistake."</p> <p>David answered and said, "Here is the spear, O king! Let one of the young men come over and take it.</p> <p>The LORD rewards every man for his righteousness and his faithfulness, for the LORD gave You into my hand today. I would not put out my hand against the LORD's anointed.</p> <p>See, as Your life was precious this day in my sight, so may my life be precious in the sight of the LORD, and may He deliver me out of all tribulation."</p> <p>Then Saul said to David, "Blessed be you, my son David! You will do many things and will succeed in them." So David went his way, and Saul returned to his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Saul (SAWL) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Sam 23:19

v2 — 1 Sam 24:2

v5 — 1 Sam 17:55

v6 — Judg 7:10-11

v9 — 2 Sam 1:14; 2 Sam 1:16; Ps 105:15

v10 — Gen 47:29; Deut 31:14; Rom 12:19; 1 Sam 31:6; Ps 37:13

v11 — 1 Sam 24:6

v12 — Gen 2:21; Gen 15:12

v17 — 1 Sam 24:16

v18 — 1 Sam 24:9; 1 Sam 24:11-14

v19 — 2 Sam 14:16; 2 Sam 16:11; 2 Sam 20:19

v21 — 1 Sam 24:17; 1 Sam 15:24

Chapter 27

David fled to the Philistine city of Gath and was given the town of Ziklag by King Achish. He raided various southern peoples for sixteen months while telling Achish he was raiding Judah, gaining the Philistine king's trust.

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| <p>1 <i>And David said in his heart, I shall now perish one day by the hand of Saul: there is nothing better for me than that I should speedily escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul shall despair of me, to seek me any more in any coast of Israel: so shall I escape out of his hand.</i></p> | <p>Then David said in his heart, "Now I shall perish one day by the hand of Saul. There is nothing better for me than that I should escape to the land of the Philistines. Then Saul will despair of seeking me any longer within the borders of Israel. I will escape out of his hand."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And David arose, and he passed over with the six hundred men that were with him unto Achish, the son of Maach, king of Gath.</i></p> | <p>So David arose and went over, he and the six hundred men who were with him, to Achish the son of Maach, king of Gath.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And David dwelt with Achish at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, even David with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the Carmelitess, Nabal's wife.</i></p> | <p>David lived with Achish at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, and David with his two wives, Ahinoam of Jezreel and Abigail of Carmel, Nabal's widow.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And it was told Saul that David was fled to Gath: and he sought no more again for him.</i></p> | <p>When it was told Saul that David had fled to Gath, he no longer sought him.</p> |

- 5 *And David said unto Achish, If I have now found grace in thine eyes, let them give me a place in some town in the country, that I may dwell there: for why should thy servant dwell in the royal city with thee?* Then David said to Achish, "If I have found favor in your eyes, let a place be given me in one of the country towns, that I may dwell there. For why should your servant dwell in the royal city with you?"
- 6 *Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: wherefore Ziklag pertaineth unto the kings of Judah unto this day.* So that day Achish gave him Ziklag. Therefore Ziklag has belonged to the kings of Judah to this day.
- 7 *And the time that David dwelt in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months.* The number of days that David lived in the country of the Philistines was a year and four months.
- 8 *And David and his men went up, and invaded the Geshurites, and the Gezrites, and the Amalekites: for those nations were of old the inhabitants of the land, as thou goest to Shur, even unto the land of Egypt.* Now David and his men went up and raided the Geshurites, the Girzites, and the Amalekites, for these were the inhabitants of the land from of old, as far as Shur, to the land of Egypt.
- 9 *And David smote the land, and left neither man nor woman alive, and took away the sheep, and the oxen, and the asses, and the camels, and the apparel, and returned, and came to Achish.* David would strike the land and would leave neither man nor woman alive, but would take away the sheep, the oxen, the donkeys, the camels, and the garments, and come back to Achish.
- 10 *And Achish said, Whither have ye made a road to day? And David said, Against the south of Judah, and against the south of the Jerahmeelites, and against the south of the Kenites.* When Achish asked, "Where have you made a raid today?" David would say, "Against the south of Judah," or "Against the south of the Jerahmeelites," or "Against the south of the Kenites."

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| <p>11 <i>And David saved neither man nor woman alive, to bring tidings to Gath, saying, Lest they should tell on us, saying, So did David, and so will be his manner all the while he dwelleth in the country of the Philistines.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Achish believed David, saying, He hath made his people Israel utterly to abhor him; therefore he shall be my servant for ever.</i></p> | <p>David would leave neither man nor woman alive to bring news to Gath, thinking, "Lest they tell about us and say, 'So David has done.' " Such was his custom all the while he lived in the country of the Philistines.</p> <p>Achish trusted David, thinking, "He has made himself an utter stench to his people Israel; therefore he shall always be my servant."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 40:27-31

v7 — 1 Sam 29:3

v8 — Josh 13:2; 1 Sam 15:7-8

v10 — Judg 1:16

Chapter 28

The Philistines assembled to fight Israel, and Saul, terrified and unable to hear from God, sought out the medium at Endor. The spirit of Samuel appeared and told Saul that the LORD had departed from him and that he and his sons would die the next day.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass in those days, that the Philistines gathered their armies together for warfare, to fight with Israel. And Achish said unto David, Know thou assuredly, that thou shalt go out with me to battle, thou and thy men.</i></p> | <p>In those days the Philistines gathered their forces for war, to fight against Israel. And Achish said to David, "You understand that you and your men are to go out with me in the army."</p> |
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- 2 *And David said to Achish, Surely thou shalt know what thy servant can do. And Achish said to David, Therefore will I make thee keeper of mine head for ever.* David said to Achish, "Very well, you shall know what your servant can do." And Achish said to David, "Very well, I will make you my bodyguard for life."
- 3 *Now Samuel was dead, and all Israel had lamented him, and buried him in Ramah, even in his own city. And Saul had put away those that had familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land.* Now Samuel had died. All Israel had mourned for him and buried him in Ramah, his own city. And Saul had put those that had familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land.
- 4 *And the Philistines gathered themselves together, and came and pitched in Shunem: and Saul gathered all Israel together, and they pitched in Gilboa.* The Philistines assembled and came and encamped at Shunem. And Saul gathered all Israel. They encamped at Gilboa.
- 5 *And when Saul saw the host of the Philistines, he was afraid, and his heart greatly trembled.* When Saul saw the army of the Philistines, he was afraid. His heart trembled greatly.
- 6 *And when Saul enquired of the LORD, the LORD answered him not, neither by dreams, nor by Urim, nor by prophets.* When Saul inquired of the LORD, the LORD did not answer Him, either by dreams, or by Urim, or by prophets.
- 7 *Then said Saul unto his servants, Seek me a woman that hath a familiar spirit, that I may go to her, and enquire of her. And his servants said to him, Behold, there is a woman that hath a familiar spirit at Endor.* Then Saul said to his servants, "Seek out for me a woman who has a familiar spirit, that I may go to her and inquire of her." And his servants said to him, "See, there is a woman who has a familiar spirit at En-dor."

- 8 *And Saul disguised himself, and put on other raiment, and he went, and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night: and he said, I pray thee, divine unto me by the familiar spirit, and bring me him up, whom I shall name unto thee.* So Saul disguised himself and put on other garments and went, he and two men with him. And they came to the woman by night. And he said, "Divine unto me by the familiar spirit and bring up for me whomever I shall name to you."
- 9 *And the woman said unto him, Behold, thou knowest what Saul hath done, how he hath cut off those that have familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land: wherefore then layest thou a snare for my life, to cause me to die?* The woman said to him, "Surely you know what Saul has done, how he has cut off those that have familiar spirits, and the wizards, from the land. Why then are you laying a trap for my life to bring about my death?"
- 10 *And Saul sware to her by the LORD, saying, As the LORD liveth, there shall no punishment happen to thee for this thing.* But Saul swore to her by the LORD, "As the LORD lives, no punishment shall come upon You for this thing."
- 11 *Then said the woman, Whom shall I bring up unto thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel.* Then the woman said, "Whom shall I bring up for you?" He said, "Bring up Samuel for me."
- 12 *And when the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice: and the woman spake to Saul, saying, Why hast thou deceived me? for thou art Saul.* When the woman saw Samuel, she cried out with a loud voice. And the woman said to Saul, "Why have you deceived me? You are Saul."
- 13 *And the king said unto her, Be not afraid: for what sawest thou? And the woman said unto Saul, I saw gods ascending out of the earth.* The king said to her, "Do not be afraid. What do you see?" And the woman said to Saul, "I saw gods ascending out of the earth."

- 14 *And he said unto her, What form is he of? And she said, An old man cometh up; and he is covered with a mantle. And Saul perceived that it was Samuel, and he stooped with his face to the ground, and bowed himself.* He said to her, "What is his appearance?" And she said, "An old man is coming up. He is wrapped in a robe." And Saul knew that it was Samuel. He bowed with his face to the ground and paid homage.
- 15 *And Samuel said to Saul, Why hast thou disquieted me, to bring me up? And Saul answered, I am sore distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and God is departed from me, and answereth me no more, neither by prophets, nor by dreams: therefore I have called thee, that thou mayest make known unto me what I shall do.* Then Samuel said to Saul, "Why have you disturbed me by bringing me up?" Saul answered, "I am in great distress, for the Philistines are warring against me. God has turned away from me and answers me no more, either by prophets or by dreams. Therefore I have summoned you to tell me what I shall do."
- 16 *Then said Samuel, Wherefore then dost thou ask of me, seeing the LORD is departed from thee, and is become thine enemy?* Samuel said, "Why then do you ask me, since the LORD has turned from You and become Your enemy?"
- 17 *And the LORD hath done to him, as he spake by me: for the LORD hath rent the kingdom out of thine hand, and given it to thy neighbour, even to David:* The LORD has done to You as He spoke by me, for the LORD has torn the kingdom out of Your hand and given it to Your neighbor, David.
- 18 *Because thou obeyedst not the voice of the LORD, nor executedst his fierce wrath upon Amalek, therefore hath the LORD done this thing unto thee this day.* Because You did not obey the voice of the LORD and did not carry out His fierce wrath against Amalek, therefore the LORD has done this thing to You this day.

- 19 *Moreover the LORD will also deliver Israel with thee into the hand of the Philistines: and to morrow shalt thou and thy sons be with me: the LORD also shall deliver the host of Israel into the hand of the Philistines.* Moreover, the LORD will give Israel also with You into the hand of the Philistines, and tomorrow You and Your sons shall be with me. The LORD will give the army of Israel also into the hand of the Philistines."
- 20 *Then Saul fell straightway all along on the earth, and was sore afraid, because of the words of Samuel: and there was no strength in him; for he had eaten no bread all the day, nor all the night.* Then Saul fell at once full length on the ground, filled with fear because of the words of Samuel. And there was no strength in him, for he had eaten nothing all day and all night.
- 21 *And the woman came unto Saul, and saw that he was sore troubled, and said unto him, Behold, thine handmaid hath obeyed thy voice, and I have put my life in my hand, and have hearkened unto thy words which thou spakest unto me.* The woman came to Saul, and when she saw that he was terrified, she said to him, "See, your servant has obeyed you. I have taken my life in my hand and have listened to what you said to me.
- 22 *Now therefore, I pray thee, hearken thou also unto the voice of thine handmaid, and let me set a morsel of bread before thee; and eat, that thou mayest have strength, when thou goest on thy way.* Now therefore, you also obey your servant. Let me set a morsel of bread before you, and eat, that you may have strength when you go on your way."
- 23 *But he refused, and said, I will not eat. But his servants, together with the woman, compelled him; and he hearkened unto their voice. So he arose from the earth, and sat upon the bed.* He refused and said, "I will not eat." But his servants, together with the woman, urged him. He listened to their words. So he arose from the earth and sat on the bed.
- 24 *And the woman had a fat calf in the house; and she hasted, and killed it, and took flour, and kneaded it, and did bake unleavened bread thereof:* Now the woman had a fattened calf in the house. She quickly killed it. She took flour and kneaded it and baked unleavened bread of it,

- 25 *And she brought it before Saul, and before his servants; and they did eat. Then they rose up, and went away that night.* She put it before Saul and his servants. They ate. Then they rose and went away that night.
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Words in this chapter:

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Lev 19:31; Lev 20:27; 1 Sam 25:1; Ex 22:18
- v4 — Josh 19:18; 1 Sam 31:1
- v6 — Num 12:6; 1 Sam 14:37; Lam 2:9; Num 27:21; Ezek 20:1-3
- v7 — Acts 16:16
- v14 — 1 Sam 15:27
- v15 — Luke 16:23-26; 1 Sam 28:6; 1 Sam 18:12
- v21 — Judg 12:3

Chapter 29

The Philistine lords refused to let David march with them against Israel, fearing he would turn on them in battle. Achish reluctantly sent David back to Ziklag.

- 1 *Now the Philistines gathered together all their armies to Aphek: and the Israelites pitched by a fountain which is in Jezreel.* Now the Philistines had gathered all their forces at Aphek. And the Israelites were encamped by the spring that is in Jezreel.
- 2 *And the lords of the Philistines passed on by hundreds, and by thousands: but David and his men passed on in the rereward with Achish.* As the lords of the Philistines were passing on by hundreds and by thousands, and David and his men were passing on in the rear with Achish,

- 3 *Then said the princes of the Philistines, What are these Hebrews here? And Achish said unto the princes of the Philistines, Is not this David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, which hath been with me these days, or these years, and I have found no fault in him since he fell unto me unto this day?* The commanders of the Philistines said, "What are these Hebrews doing here?" And Achish said to the commanders of the Philistines, "Is this not David, the servant of Saul, king of Israel, who has been with me now for days and years, and since he deserted to me I have found no fault in him to this day."
- 4 *And the princes of the Philistines were wroth with him; and the princes of the Philistines said unto him, Make this fellow return, that he may go again to his place which thou hast appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, lest in the battle he be an adversary to us: for wherewith should he reconcile himself unto his master? should it not be with the heads of these men?* But the commanders of the Philistines were angry with him. And the commanders of the Philistines said to him, "Send the man back, that he may return to the place to which you have assigned him. He shall not go down with us into battle, lest in the battle he become an adversary to us. For how could this fellow reconcile himself to his lord? Would it not be with the heads of the men here?"
- 5 *Is not this David, of whom they sang one to another in dances, saying, Saul slew his thousands, and David his ten thousands?* Is not this David, of whom they sing to one another in dances, 'Saul has struck down his thousands, and David his ten thousands'?"
- 6 *Then Achish called David, and said unto him, Surely, as the LORD liveth, thou hast been upright, and thy going out and thy coming in with me in the host is good in my sight: for I have not found evil in thee since the day of thy coming unto me unto this day: nevertheless the lords favour thee not.* Then Achish called David and said to him, "As the LORD lives, You have been honest, and to me it seems right that You should march out and in with me in the campaign. For I have found nothing wrong in You from the day of Your coming to me to this day. Nevertheless, the lords do not approve of You.
- 7 *Wherefore now return, and go in peace, that thou displease not the lords of the Philistines.* So go back now and go peaceably, that You may not displease the lords of the Philistines."

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| <p>8 <i>And David said unto Achish, But what have I done? and what hast thou found in thy servant so long as I have been with thee unto this day, that I may not go fight against the enemies of my lord the king?</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Achish answered and said to David, I know that thou art good in my sight, as an angel of God: notwithstanding the princes of the Philistines have said, He shall not go up with us to the battle.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Wherefore now rise up early in the morning with thy master's servants that are come with thee: and as soon as ye be up early in the morning, and have light, depart.</i></p> <p>11 <i>So David and his men rose up early to depart in the morning, to return into the land of the Philistines. And the Philistines went up to Jezreel.</i></p> | <p>David said to Achish, "But what have I done? What have you found in your servant from the day I entered your service until now, that I may not go and fight against the enemies of my lord the king?"</p> <p>Achish answered David, "I know that you are as blameless in my sight as an angel of God. Nevertheless, the commanders of the Philistines have said, 'He shall not go up with us to the battle.'</p> <p>Now then rise early in the morning with the servants of your lord who came with you, and start early in the morning, and depart as soon as you have light."</p> <p>So David set out with his men early in the morning to return to the land of the Philistines. But the Philistines went up to Jezreel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 4:1
- v3 — 1 Sam 27:7; Dan 6:5
- v4 — 1 Sam 14:21
- v5 — 1 Sam 21:11
- v9 — 2 Sam 14:20; 2 Sam 14:17; 2 Sam 19:27

Chapter 30

David returned to Ziklag to find it burned and all the women and children taken captive by the Amalekites. He pursued, overtook them, and recovered everything; he then divided the spoil equally between those who fought and those who guarded the baggage.

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| 1 <i>And it came to pass, when David and his men were come to Ziklag on the third day, that the Amalekites had invaded the south, and Ziklag, and smitten Ziklag, and burned it with fire;</i> | Now when David and his men came to Ziklag on the third day, the Amalekites had made a raid against the south and against Ziklag. They had struck Ziklag and burned it with fire |
| 2 <i>And had taken the women captives, that were therein: they slew not any, either great or small, but carried them away, and went on their way.</i> | Taken captive the women and all who were in it, both small and great. They killed no one, but carried them off and went their way. |
| 3 <i>So David and his men came to the city, and, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captives.</i> | When David and his men came to the city, they found it burned with fire. Their wives and sons and daughters taken captive. |
| 4 <i>Then David and the people that were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep.</i> | Then David and the people who were with him raised their voices and wept until they had no more strength to weep. |
| 5 <i>And David's two wives were taken captives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite.</i> | David's two wives also had been taken captive, Ahinoam of Jezreel and Abigail the widow of Nabal of Carmel. |
| 6 <i>And David was greatly distressed; for the people spake of stoning him, because the soul of all the people was grieved, every man for his sons and for his daughters: but David encouraged himself in the LORD his God.</i> | David was greatly distressed, for the people spoke of stoning him, because all the people were bitter in soul, each for his sons and daughters. But David strengthened himself in the LORD His God. |

- 7 *And David said to Abiathar the priest, Ahimelech's son, I pray thee, bring me hither the ephod. And Abiathar brought thither the ephod to David.* David said to Abiathar the priest, the son of Ahimelech, "Bring me the ephod." So Abiathar brought the ephod to David.
- 8 *And David enquired at the LORD, saying, Shall I pursue after this troop? shall I overtake them? And he answered him, Pursue: for thou shalt surely overtake them, and without fail recover all.* David inquired of the LORD, "Shall I pursue after this band? Shall I overtake them?" He answered Him, "Pursue, for You shall surely overtake and shall surely rescue."
- 9 *So David went, he and the six hundred men that were with him, and came to the brook Besor, where those that were left behind stayed.* So David set out, and the six hundred men who were with him. They came to the brook Besor, where those who were left behind stayed.
- 10 *But David pursued, he and four hundred men: for two hundred abode behind, which were so faint that they could not go over the brook Besor.* But David pursued, he and four hundred men. Two hundred stayed behind, who were too exhausted to cross the brook Besor.
- 11 *And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he did eat; and they made him drink water;* They found an Egyptian in the open country and brought him to David. And they gave him bread and he ate. They gave him water to drink,
- 12 *And they gave him a piece of a cake of figs, and two clusters of raisins: and when he had eaten, his spirit came again to him: for he had eaten no bread, nor drunk any water, three days and three nights.* They gave him a piece of a cake of figs and two clusters of raisins. And when he had eaten, his spirit revived, for he had not eaten bread or drunk water for three days and three nights.
- 13 *And David said unto him, To whom belondest thou? and whence art thou? And he said, I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I fell sick.* David said to him, "To whom do you belong? And where are you from?" He said, "I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite, and my master left me behind because I fell sick three days ago."

- 14 *We made an invasion upon the south of the Cherethites, and upon the coast which belongeth to Judah, and upon the south of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire.* We had made a raid against the south of the Cherethites and against that which belongs to Judah and against the south of Caleb. We burned Ziklag with fire."
- 15 *And David said to him, Canst thou bring me down to this company? And he said, Swear unto me by God, that thou wilt neither kill me, nor deliver me into the hands of my master, and I will bring thee down to this company.* David said to him, "Will you take me down to this band?" And he said, "Swear to me by God that you will not kill me or deliver me into the hands of my master. I will take you down to this band."
- 16 *And when he had brought him down, behold, they were spread abroad upon all the earth, eating and drinking, and dancing, because of all the great spoil that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah.* When he had taken him down, there they were, spread out over all the land, eating and drinking and dancing, because of all the great spoil they had taken from the land of the Philistines and from the land of Judah.
- 17 *And David smote them from the twilight even unto the evening of the next day: and there escaped not a man of them, save four hundred young men, which rode upon camels, and fled.* David struck them down from twilight until the evening of the next day, and not a man of them escaped, except four hundred young men, who mounted camels and fled.
- 18 *And David recovered all that the Amalekites had carried away: and David rescued his two wives.* David recovered all that the Amalekites had taken, and David rescued his two wives.
- 19 *And there was nothing lacking to them, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither spoil, nor any thing that they had taken to them: David recovered all.* Nothing was missing, whether small or great, sons or daughters, spoil or anything that had been taken. David brought back everything.

- 20 *And David took all the flocks and the herds, which they drove before those other cattle, and said, This is David's spoil.* David also captured all the flocks and herds, and the people drove the livestock before him, and said, "This is David's spoil."
- 21 *And David came to the two hundred men, which were so faint that they could not follow David, whom they had made also to abide at the brook Besor: and they went forth to meet David, and to meet the people that were with him: and when David came near to the people, he saluted them.* Then David came to the two hundred men who had been too exhausted to follow David, and who had been left at the brook Besor. And they went out to meet David and to meet the people who were with him. And when David came near to the people, he greeted them.
- 22 *Then answered all the wicked men and men of Belial, of those that went with David, and said, Because they went not with us, we will not give them ought of the spoil that we have recovered, save to every man his wife and his children, that they may lead them away, and depart.* Then all the wicked and worthless fellows among the men who had gone with David said, "Because they did not go with us, we will not give them any of the spoil that we have recovered, except that each man may lead away his wife and children, and depart."
- 23 *Then said David, Ye shall not do so, my brethren, with that which the LORD hath given us, who hath preserved us, and delivered the company that came against us into our hand.* But David said, "You shall not do so, my brothers, with what the LORD has given us. He has preserved us and given into our hand the band that came against us."
- 24 *For who will hearken unto you in this matter? but as his part is that goeth down to the battle, so shall his part be that tarrieth by the stuff: they shall part alike.* Who would listen to You in this matter? For as His share is who goes down into the battle, so shall His share be who stays by the baggage. They shall share alike."
- 25 *And it was so from that day forward, that he made it a statute and an ordinance for Israel unto this day.* He made it a statute and a rule for Israel from that day forward to this day.

- 26 *And when David came to Ziklag, he sent of the spoil unto the elders of Judah, even to his friends, saying, Behold a present for you of the spoil of the enemies of the LORD;* When David came to Ziklag, he sent part of the spoil to His friends, the elders of Judah, saying, "Here is a present for You from the spoil of the enemies of the LORD."
- 27 *To them which were in Bethel, and to them which were in south Ramoth, and to them which were in Jattir,* He sent it to those in Bethel, in south Ramoth, in Jattir,
- 28 *And to them which were in Aroer, and to them which were in Siphmoth, and to them which were in Eshtemoa,* In Aroer, in Siphmoth, in Eshtemoa,
- 29 *And to them which were in Rachal, and to them which were in the cities of the Jerahmeelites, and to them which were in the cities of the Kenites,* In Racal, in the cities of the Jerahmeelites, in the cities of the Kenites,
- 30 *And to them which were in Hormah, and to them which were in Chorashan, and to them which were in Athach,* In Hormah, in Bor-ashan, in Athach,
- 31 *And to them which were in Hebron, and to all the places where David himself and his men were wont to haunt.* In Hebron, and in all the places where David and his men had roamed.

Words in this chapter:

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Sam 29:11; 1 Sam 15:7
v6 — Ps 56:3-4; Ps 56:11; Ps 62:5; Ps 27:1-3; Ps 18:6
v8 — 1 Sam 30:18; 1 Sam 23:2; Prov 3:5-6; 2 Sam 5:19; Ps 91:15
v12 — Judg 15:19
v14 — Ezek 25:16; 2 Sam 8:18; Zeph 2:5; 1 Kgs 1:38; 1 Kgs 1:44
v18 — Gen 14:16
v19 — 1 Sam 30:8; Ps 91:9-10
v20 — 1 Sam 30:26

v24 — Josh 22:8; Num 31:27; Ps 68:12

v27 — Josh 15:48

v28 — Josh 15:50; Josh 13:16

v29 — Judg 1:16; 1 Sam 27:10

Chapter 31

The Philistines defeated Israel at the battle of Mount Gilboa; Saul's sons Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malchi-shua were killed. Saul, badly wounded, fell on his own sword; the men of Jabesh-gilead recovered the bodies and buried them.

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| 1 | <i>Now the Philistines fought against Israel: and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.</i> | Now the Philistines fought against Israel, and the men of Israel fled before the Philistines and fell slain on Mount Gilboa. |
| 2 | <i>And the Philistines followed hard upon Saul and upon his sons; and the Philistines slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Malchishua, Saul's sons.</i> | The Philistines overtook Saul and his sons, and the Philistines struck down Jonathan and Abinadab and Malchi-shua, the sons of Saul. |
| 3 | <i>And the battle went sore against Saul, and the archers hit him; and he was sore wounded of the archers.</i> | The battle pressed hard against Saul, and the archers found him. He was badly wounded by the archers. |
| 4 | <i>Then said Saul unto his armourbearer, Draw thy sword, and thrust me through therewith; lest these uncircumcised come and thrust me through, and abuse me. But his armourbearer would not; for he was sore afraid. Therefore Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.</i> | Then Saul said to his armor-bearer, "Draw your sword, and thrust me through with it, lest these uncircumcised come and thrust me through, and mistreat me." But his armor-bearer would not, for he feared greatly. Therefore Saul took his own sword and fell upon it. |
| 5 | <i>And when his armourbearer saw that Saul was dead, he fell likewise upon his sword, and died with him.</i> | When his armor-bearer saw that Saul was dead, he also fell upon his sword and died with him. |
| 6 | <i>So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armourbearer, and all his men, that same day together.</i> | Thus Saul died. His three sons, his armor-bearer. All his men, on the same day together. |

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| <p>7 <i>And when the men of Israel that were on the other side of the valley, and they that were on the other side Jordan, saw that the men of Israel fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, they forsook the cities, and fled; and the Philistines came and dwelt in them.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And it came to pass on the morrow, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his three sons fallen in mount Gilboa.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And they cut off his head, and stripped off his armour, and sent into the land of the Philistines round about, to publish it in the house of their idols, and among the people.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And they put his armour in the house of Ashtaroth: and they fastened his body to the wall of Bethshan.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And when the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead heard of that which the Philistines had done to Saul;</i></p> <p>12 <i>All the valiant men arose, and went all night, and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Bethshan, and came to Jabesh, and burnt them there.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And they took their bones, and buried them under a tree at Jabesh, and fasted seven days.</i></p> | <p>When the men of Israel who were on the other side of the valley and those beyond the Jordan saw that the men of Israel had fled and that Saul and his sons were dead, they abandoned their cities and fled, and the Philistines came and lived in them.</p> <p>The next day, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, they found Saul and his three sons fallen on Mount Gilboa.</p> <p>So they cut off his head and stripped off his armor and sent messengers throughout the land of the Philistines, to carry the good news to the house of their idols and to the people.</p> <p>They put his armor in the temple of Ashtaroth. They fastened his body to the wall of Beth-shan.</p> <p>But when the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead heard what the Philistines had done to Saul,</p> <p>All the valiant men arose and went all night and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth-shan. They came to Jabesh and burned them there.</p> <p>They took their bones and buried them under the tamarisk tree in Jabesh and fasted seven days.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 10:1-12; 1 Sam 28:4
- v4** — Judg 9:54; 2 Sam 1:9-10; 2 Sam 1:6
- v9** — 2 Sam 1:20
- v10** — Judg 2:13; Josh 17:11
- v12** — 2 Chr 16:14
- v13** — Gen 50:10; 2 Sam 21:12-14

2 Samuel

Author: Unknown — likely compiled from court records, possibly by Nathan, Gad, or other prophetic writers associated with David's reign (cf. 1 Chr 29:29).

Date written: c. 930–722 BC, drawing on earlier sources; final form perhaps during the divided monarchy.

Written to: The people of Israel, as part of the unified historical account running from Judges through Kings.

Setting: Saul is dead. Israel is without a king. 2 Samuel covers David's entire reign — his rise to power over a divided nation, his military victories, the Davidic covenant, his great sin with Bathsheba, and the long consequences that followed.

Where this sits historically: c. 1010–970 BC — David's united reign over all Israel from Hebron and then Jerusalem; the surrounding empires are weak, giving Israel its widest historical borders.

Contemporaries: Hiram I of Tyre (David's ally); Egypt's weak 21st dynasty; the Aramean kingdoms of Zobah and Damascus; the prophets Nathan and Gad. 1 Chronicles retells this same period from a priestly angle.

Big themes:

- The Davidic covenant — God's unconditional promise that David's line will rule forever and that a son of David will build God's house (2 Sam 7) is the theological center of the book and of the entire Bible's royal storyline
- Sin and its consequences — David's adultery with Bathsheba and murder of Uriah trigger a chain of violence within his own household that never fully subsides
- Grace in failure — David falls catastrophically, but God does not abandon him or revoke His covenant; David's repentance (Ps 51) is the model for the penitent
- Leadership and loyalty — Joab, Absalom, Mephibosheth, and Shimei each illustrate different responses to power and covenant
- Jerusalem — David captures the city and makes it the political and spiritual center of the nation

Key passages: 2 Sam 7:12–16; 11:4; 12:13; 22:2–4; 23:5

How it fits: 2 Samuel is the fulfillment of the Davidic promise that begins in 1 Samuel and runs through the entire OT. The covenant of chapter 7 is the lens through which every subsequent king is evaluated. The NT opens by calling Jesus "the son of David" — 2 Samuel is where that title gets its weight.

Psalms tied to this book:

| Psalm | Event | Reference |

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| Ps 18 | *David delivered from all his enemies* | 2 Sam 22 (*paralleled*) |

| Ps 51 | *David's repentance after Bathsheba* | 2 Sam 11–12 |

| Ps 3 | *David flees from Absalom* | 2 Sam 15 |

| Ps 30 | *Dedication of the altar site* | 2 Sam 24 / *future temple* |

Chapter 1

An Amalekite brought news of Saul's death to David, claiming he had killed Saul at his request; David ordered the man executed for striking the LORD's anointed. David composed a lament for Saul and Jonathan, mourning their deaths.

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| 1 | <i>Now it came to pass after the death of Saul, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Amalekites, and David had abode two days in Ziklag;</i> | After the death of Saul, when David had returned from striking down the Amalekites, David remained two days in Ziklag. |
| 2 | <i>It came even to pass on the third day, that, behold, a man came out of the camp from Saul with his clothes rent, and earth upon his head: and so it was, when he came to David, that he fell to the earth, and did obeisance.</i> | On the third day, a man came from Saul's camp, with his clothes torn and dirt on his head. When he came to David, he fell to the ground and paid homage. |
| 3 | <i>And David said unto him, From whence comest thou? And he said unto him, Out of the camp of Israel am I escaped.</i> | David said to him, "Where do you come from?" And he said to him, "I have escaped from the camp of Israel." |
| 4 | <i>And David said unto him, How went the matter? I pray thee, tell me. And he answered, That the people are fled from the battle, and many of the people also are fallen and dead; and Saul and Jonathan his son are dead also.</i> | David said to him, "How did it go? Tell me." And he answered, "The people fled from the battle, and also many of the people have fallen and are dead, and Saul and his son Jonathan are also dead." |
| 5 | <i>And David said unto the young man that told him, How knowest thou that Saul and Jonathan his son be dead?</i> | Then David said to the young man who told him, "How do you know that Saul and his son Jonathan are dead?" |

- 6 *And the young man that told him said, As I happened by chance upon mount Gilboa, behold, Saul leaned upon his spear; and, lo, the chariots and horsemen followed hard after him.* The young man who told him said, "By chance I happened to be on Mount Gilboa, and there was Saul leaning on his spear, and the chariots and the horsemen were close upon him.
- 7 *And when he looked behind him, he saw me, and called unto me. And I answered, Here am I.* When he looked behind him, he saw me, and called to me. And I answered, 'Here I am.'
- 8 *And he said unto me, Who art thou? And I answered him, I am an Amalekite.* He said to me, 'Who are you?' I answered him, 'I am an Amalekite.'
- 9 *He said unto me again, Stand, I pray thee, upon me, and slay me: for anguish is come upon me, because my life is yet whole in me.* He said to me, 'Stand beside me and kill me, for anguish has seized me, and yet my life still lingers.'
- 10 *So I stood upon him, and slew him, because I was sure that he could not live after that he was fallen: and I took the crown that was upon his head, and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them hither unto my lord.* So I stood beside him and killed him, because I was sure that he could not live after he had fallen. And I took the crown that was on his head and the armlet that was on his arm. I have brought them here to my lord."
- 11 *Then David took hold on his clothes, and rent them; and likewise all the men that were with him:* Then David took hold of his clothes and tore them, and so did all the men who were with him.
- 12 *And they mourned, and wept, and fasted until even, for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of the LORD, and for the house of Israel; because they were fallen by the sword.* They mourned and wept and fasted until evening for Saul and for Jonathan his son and for the people of the LORD and for the house of Israel, because they had fallen by the sword.
- 13 *And David said unto the young man that told him, Whence art thou? And he answered, I am the son of a stranger, an Amalekite.* David said to the young man who told him, "Where do you come from?" And he answered, "I am the son of a sojourner, an Amalekite."

- 14 *And David said unto him, How wast thou not afraid to stretch forth thine hand to destroy the LORD'S anointed?* David said to him, "How is it you were not afraid to put out Your hand to destroy the LORD's anointed?"
- 15 *And David called one of the young men, and said, Go near, and fall upon him. And he smote him that he died.* Then David called one of the young men and said, "Go, execute him." And he struck him down so that he died.
- 16 *And David said unto him, Thy blood be upon thy head; for thy mouth hath testified against thee, saying, I have slain the LORD'S anointed.* David said to him, "Your blood be on your head, for Your own mouth has testified against You, saying, 'I have killed the LORD's anointed.' "
- 17 *And David lamented with this lamentation over Saul and over Jonathan his son:* David lamented with this lament over Saul and Jonathan his son,
- 18 *(Also he bade them teach the children of Judah the use of the bow: behold, it is written in the book of Jasher.)* He said it should be taught to the people of Judah; it is written in the Book of Jasher. He said:
- 19 *The beauty of Israel is slain upon thy high places: how are the mighty fallen!* "Your glory, O Israel, is slain on your high places! How the mighty have fallen!
- 20 *Tell it not in Gath, publish it not in the streets of Askelon; lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised triumph.* Tell it not in Gath, proclaim it not in the streets of Ashkelon, lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised exult.
- 21 *Ye mountains of Gilboa, let there be no dew, neither let there be rain, upon you, nor fields of offerings: for there the shield of the mighty is vilely cast away, the shield of Saul, as though he had not been anointed with oil.* You mountains of Gilboa, let there be no dew or rain upon you, nor fields of offerings! For there the shield of the mighty was defiled, the shield of Saul, not anointed with oil.

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| <p>22 <i>From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty, the bow of Jonathan turned not back, and the sword of Saul returned not empty.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Saul and Jonathan were lovely and pleasant in their lives, and in their death they were not divided: they were swifter than eagles, they were stronger than lions.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Ye daughters of Israel, weep over Saul, who clothed you in scarlet, with other delights, who put on ornaments of gold upon your apparel.</i></p> <p>25 <i>How are the mighty fallen in the midst of the battle! O Jonathan, thou wast slain in thine high places.</i></p> <p>26 <i>I am distressed for thee, my brother Jonathan: very pleasant hast thou been unto me: thy love to me was wonderful, passing the love of women.</i></p> <p>27 <i>How are the mighty fallen, and the weapons of war perished!</i></p> | <p>From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty, the bow of Jonathan turned not back, and the sword of Saul returned not empty.</p> <p>Saul and Jonathan, beloved and lovely! In life and in death they were not divided; they were swifter than eagles; they were stronger than lions.</p> <p>You daughters of Israel, weep over Saul, who clothed you luxuriously in scarlet, who put ornaments of gold on your garments.</p> <p>How the mighty have fallen in the midst of the battle! Jonathan lies slain on your high places.</p> <p>I am distressed for you, my brother Jonathan; very pleasant have you been to me; your love to me was extraordinary, surpassing the love of women.</p> <p>How the mighty have fallen, and the weapons of war perished!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sojourner — A temporary resident in a foreign land — one who lives among a people but is not a citizen; a stranger passing through.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked'

for.'

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 Sam 4:12
v4 — 1 Sam 4:16; 1 Sam 31:1-6; 1 Chr 10:1-6
v10 — Judg 9:54; Matt 7:2
v11 — 2 Sam 13:31
v14 — 1 Sam 26:9; 1 Sam 24:6; Ps 105:15; 2 Pet 2:10; 1 Sam 31:4
v16 — Matt 27:25; Luke 19:22
v17 — 2 Chr 35:25
v18 — Josh 10:13
v19 — 2 Sam 1:27; Deut 4:7-8; 2 Sam 1:25
v23 — Jer 4:13
v26 — 1 Sam 20:17; 1 Sam 18:1-4; 1 Sam 20:41
v27 — 2 Sam 1:25; 2 Sam 1:19

Chapter 2

David was anointed king over Judah at Hebron, while Abner made Saul's son Ish-bosheth king over the rest of Israel. War broke out between the two houses, and at the battle of Gibeon, Abner killed Joab's brother Asahel.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass after this, that David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah? And the LORD said unto him, Go up. And David said, Whither shall I go up? And he said, Unto Hebron.</i></p> | <p>After this David inquired of the LORD, "Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah?" And the LORD said to Him, "Go up." David said, "Where shall I go up?" And he said, "To Hebron."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>So David went up thither, and his two wives also, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail Nabal's wife the Carmelite.</i></p> | <p>So David went up there. His two wives also, Ahinoam of Jezreel and Abigail the widow of Nabal of Carmel.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And his men that were with him did David bring up, every man with his household: and they dwelt in the cities of Hebron.</i></p> | <p>David brought up his men who were with him, every man with his household. They lived in the towns of Hebron.</p> |

- 4 *And the men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. And they told David, saying, That the men of Jabeshgilead were they that buried Saul.* The men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. When they told David, "It was the men of Jabesh-gilead who buried Saul,"
- 5 *And David sent messengers unto the men of Jabeshgilead, and said unto them, Blessed be ye of the LORD, that ye have shewed this kindness unto your lord, even unto Saul, and have buried him.* David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh-gilead and said to them, "May you be blessed by the LORD, because you showed this loyalty to Saul your lord and buried him.
- 6 *And now the LORD shew kindness and truth unto you: and I also will requite you this kindness, because ye have done this thing.* Now may the LORD show mercy and truth to You. And I will do good to You because You have done this thing.
- 7 *Therefore now let your hands be strengthened, and be ye valiant: for your master Saul is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them.* Now therefore let your hands be strong, and be valiant, for Saul your lord is dead, and the house of Judah has anointed me king over them."
- 8 *But Abner the son of Ner, captain of Saul's host, took Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and brought him over to Mahanaim;* But Abner the son of Ner, commander of Saul's army, took Ish-bosheth the son of Saul and brought him over to Mahanaim,
- 9 *And made him king over Gilead, and over the Ashurites, and over Jezreel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and over all Israel.* He made him king over Gilead and the Ashurites and Jezreel and Ephraim and Benjamin and all Israel.
- 10 *Ishbosheth Saul's son was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David.* Ish-bosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel. He reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David.
- 11 *And the time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.* The time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.

- 12 *And Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ishbosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon.* Then Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon.
- 13 *And Joab the son of Zeruiah, and the servants of David, went out, and met together by the pool of Gibeon: and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool, and the other on the other side of the pool.* Joab the son of Zeruiah and the servants of David went out and met them at the pool of Gibeon. And they sat down, the one on one side of the pool and the other on the other side of the pool.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joab** (JOH-ab) — "the LORD is father" — Son of Zeruiah (David's sister), commander of David's army throughout his reign. A brilliant but ruthless general who murdered Abner and Absalom against David's wishes. David charged Solomon to deal with him on his deathbed.

- 14 *And Abner said to Joab, Let the young men now arise, and play before us. And Joab said, Let them arise.* Abner said to Joab, "Let the young men arise and compete before us." And Joab said, "Let them arise."
- 15 *Then there arose and went over by number twelve of Benjamin, which pertained to Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David.* Then they arose and crossed over by number, twelve for Benjamin and Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David.
- 16 *And they caught every one his fellow by the head, and thrust his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together: wherefore that place was called Helkathhazzurim, which is in Gibeon.* Each caught his opponent by the head and thrust his sword in his opponent's side, so they fell down together. Therefore that place was called Helkath-hazzurim, which is at Gibeon.
- 17 *And there was a very sore battle that day; and Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before the servants of David.* The battle was very fierce that day. And Abner and the men of Israel were beaten before the servants of David.
- 18 *And there were three sons of Zeruiah there, Joab, and Abishai, and Asahel: and Asahel was as light of foot as a wild roe.* The three sons of Zeruiah were there, Joab, Abishai, and Asahel. Now Asahel was as swift of foot as a wild gazelle.

- 19 *And Asahel pursued after Abner; and in going he turned not to the right hand nor to the left from following Abner.* Asahel pursued Abner, and as he went he did not turn to the right or to the left from following Abner.
- 20 *Then Abner looked behind him, and said, Art thou Asahel? And he answered, I am.* Then Abner looked behind him and said, "Is it you, Asahel?" And he answered, "It is I."
- 21 *And Abner said to him, Turn thee aside to thy right hand or to thy left, and lay thee hold on one of the young men, and take thee his armour. But Asahel would not turn aside from following of him.* Abner said to him, "Turn aside to your right hand or to your left, and seize one of the young men and take his spoil." But Asahel would not turn aside from following him.
- 22 *And Abner said again to Asahel, Turn thee aside from following me: wherefore should I smite thee to the ground? how then should I hold up my face to Joab thy brother?* Abner said again to Asahel, "Turn aside from following me. Why should I strike you to the ground? How then could I lift my face to your brother Joab?"
- 23 *Howbeit he refused to turn aside: wherefore Abner with the hinder end of the spear smote him under the fifth rib, that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there, and died in the same place: and it came to pass, that as many as came to the place where Asahel fell down and died stood still.* But he refused to turn aside. Therefore Abner struck him in the stomach with the butt of his spear, so that the spear came out at his back. And he fell there and died where he was. And all who came to the place where Asahel had fallen and died, stood still.
- 24 *Joab also and Abishai pursued after Abner: and the sun went down when they were come to the hill of Ammah, that lieth before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon.* But Joab and Abishai pursued Abner. And as the sun was going down they came to the hill of Ammah, which lies before Giah on the way to the wilderness of Gibeon.

- 25 *And the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner, and became one troop, and stood on the top of an hill.* The people of Benjamin gathered themselves together behind Abner and became one group and stood on top of a hill.
- 26 *Then Abner called to Joab, and said, Shall the sword devour for ever? knowest thou not that it will be bitterness in the latter end? how long shall it be then, ere thou bid the people return from following their brethren?* Then Abner called to Joab, "Shall the sword devour forever? Do you not know that the end will be bitter? How long will it be before you tell your people to turn from the pursuit of their brothers?"
- 27 *And Joab said, As God liveth, unless thou hadst spoken, surely then in the morning the people had gone up every one from following his brother.* Joab said, "As God lives, if you had not spoken, surely the men would not have given up the pursuit of their brothers until the morning."
- 28 *So Joab blew a trumpet, and all the people stood still, and pursued after Israel no more, neither fought they any more.* So Joab blew the trumpet. All the people stopped and pursued Israel no further. They did not fight anymore.
- 29 *And Abner and his men walked all that night through the plain, and passed over Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and they came to Mahanaim.* Abner and his men went all that night through the Arabah. They crossed the Jordan and, marching the whole morning, they came to Mahanaim.
- 30 *And Joab returned from following Abner: and when he had gathered all the people together, there lacked of David's servants nineteen men and Asahel.* Joab returned from the pursuit of Abner. And when he had gathered all the people together, there were missing from David's servants nineteen men besides Asahel.
- 31 *But the servants of David had smitten of Benjamin, and of Abner's men, so that three hundred and threescore men died.* But the servants of David had struck down of Benjamin three hundred and sixty of Abner's men.

- 32 *And they took up Asahel, and buried him in the sepulchre of his father, which was in Bethlehem. And Joab and his men went all night, and they came to Hebron at break of day.* They took up Asahel and buried him in the tomb of his father, which was at Bethlehem. And Joab and his men marched all night, and the day broke upon them at Hebron.

Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

v1 — Prov 3:5-6; Ps 143:8; 1 Sam 30:31

v2 — 1 Sam 25:42-43

v4 — 2 Sam 5:5; 1 Sam 31:11-13

v5 — 1 Sam 23:21

v6 — Prov 14:22; Ex 34:6; Matt 5:44; Matt 5:7; 2 Tim 1:16-18

v8 — 1 Sam 14:50

v11 — 1 Kgs 2:11

v18 — 1 Chr 12:8; Hab 3:19

v23 — 2 Sam 3:27

v26 — Jer 46:14

Chapter 3

Abner defected from Ish-bosheth to David and began rallying the tribes to David's side. Joab murdered Abner at Hebron in revenge for Asahel, and David publicly mourned Abner and cursed Joab's house.

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| <p>1 <i>Now there was long war between the house of Saul and the house of David: but David waxed stronger and stronger, and the house of Saul waxed weaker and weaker.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And unto David were sons born in Hebron: and his firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess;</i></p> <p>3 <i>And his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur;</i></p> | <p>There was a long war between the house of Saul and the house of David. And David grew stronger and stronger, while the house of Saul became weaker and weaker.</p> <p>Sons were born to David at Hebron: his firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam of Jezreel;</p> <p>His second, Chileab, of Abigail the widow of Nabal of Carmel. The third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur;</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Absalom** (AB-sah-lom) — "father of peace" — David's third son, renowned for his beauty. He murdered his brother Amnon, then led a full-scale rebellion against David, temporarily seizing the throne. He was killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in an oak tree. David's grief — "O my son Absalom!" — is one of Scripture's most devastating laments.

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| <p>4 <i>And the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital;</i></p> <p>5 <i>And the sixth, Ithream, by Eglah David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And it came to pass, while there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, that Abner made himself strong for the house of Saul.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And Saul had a concubine, whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah: and Ishbosheth said to Abner, Wherefore hast thou gone in unto my father's concubine?</i></p> | <p>The fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith. The fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital;</p> <p>The sixth, Ithream, of Eglah, David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron.</p> <p>While there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, Abner was making himself strong in the house of Saul.</p> <p>Now Saul had a concubine whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah. And Ish-bosheth said to Abner, "Why have you gone in to my father's concubine?"</p> |
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- 8 *Then was Abner very wroth for the words of Ishbosheth, and said, Am I a dog's head, which against Judah do shew kindness this day unto the house of Saul thy father, to his brethren, and to his friends, and have not delivered thee into the hand of David, that thou chargest me to day with a fault concerning this woman?* Then Abner was very angry over the words of Ish-bosheth and said, "Am I a dog's head of Judah? To this day I keep showing loyalty to the house of Saul your father, to his brothers and his friends, and have not given you into the hand of David. And yet you charge me today with a fault concerning a woman.
- 9 *So do God to Abner, and more also, except, as the LORD hath sworn to David, even so I do to him;* God do so to Abner and more also, if I do not accomplish for David what the LORD has sworn to Him,
- 10 *To translate the kingdom from the house of Saul, and to set up the throne of David over Israel and over Judah, from Dan even to Beersheba.* To transfer the kingdom from the house of Saul and set up the throne of David over Israel and over Judah, from Dan to Beersheba."
- 11 *And he could not answer Abner a word again, because he feared him.* Ish-bosheth could not answer Abner another word, because he feared him.
- 12 *And Abner sent messengers to David on his behalf, saying, Whose is the land? saying also, Make thy league with me, and, behold, my hand shall be with thee, to bring about all Israel unto thee.* Abner sent messengers to David on his behalf, saying, "To whom does the land belong? Make your covenant with me, and my hand shall be with you to bring over all Israel to you."
- 13 *And he said, Well; I will make a league with thee: but one thing I require of thee, that is, Thou shalt not see my face, except thou first bring Michal Saul's daughter, when thou comest to see my face.* He said, "Good; I will make a covenant with you. But one thing I require of you: you shall not see my face unless you first bring Michal, Saul's daughter, when you come to see my face."
- 14 *And David sent messengers to Ishbosheth Saul's son, saying, Deliver me my wife Michal, which I espoused to me for an hundred foreskins of the Philistines.* Then David sent messengers to Ish-bosheth, Saul's son, saying, "Give me my wife Michal, for whom I paid the bride-price of a hundred foreskins of the Philistines."

- 15 *And Ishbosheth sent, and took her from her husband, even from Phaltiel the son of Laish.* Ish-bosheth sent and took her from her husband Paltiel the son of Laish.
- 16 *And her husband went with her along weeping behind her to Bahurim. Then said Abner unto him, Go, return. And he returned.* But her husband went with her, weeping after her all the way to Bahurim. Then Abner said to him, "Go, return." And he returned.
- 17 *And Abner had communication with the elders of Israel, saying, Ye sought for David in times past to be king over you:* Abner conferred with the elders of Israel, saying, "For some time past you have been seeking David as king over you.
- 18 *Now then do it: for the LORD hath spoken of David, saying, By the hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel out of the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies.* Now then bring it about, for the LORD has promised David, saying, 'By the hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel from the hand of the Philistines, and from the hand of all their enemies.' "
- 19 *And Abner also spake in the ears of Benjamin: and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel, and that seemed good to the whole house of Benjamin.* Abner also spoke to Benjamin. And then Abner went to tell David at Hebron all that Israel and the whole house of Benjamin thought good to do.
- 20 *So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. And David made Abner and the men that were with him a feast.* When Abner came with twenty men to David at Hebron, David made a feast for Abner and the men who were with him.
- 21 *And Abner said unto David, I will arise and go, and will gather all Israel unto my lord the king, that they may make a league with thee, and that thou mayest reign over all that thine heart desireth. And David sent Abner away; and he went in peace.* Abner said to David, "I will arise and go and will gather all Israel to my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign over all that your heart desires." So David sent Abner away. He went in peace.

- 22 *And, behold, the servants of David and Joab came from pursuing a troop, and brought in a great spoil with them: but Abner was not with David in Hebron; for he had sent him away, and he was gone in peace.* Just then the servants of David arrived with Joab from a raid, bringing much spoil with them. But Abner was not with David at Hebron, for he had sent him away. He had gone in peace.
- 23 *When Joab and all the host that was with him were come, they told Joab, saying, Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he hath sent him away, and he is gone in peace.* When Joab and all the army with him came, it was told Joab, "Abner the son of Ner came to the king. He sent him away. He has gone in peace."
- 24 *Then Joab came to the king, and said, What hast thou done? behold, Abner came unto thee; why is it that thou hast sent him away, and he is quite gone?* Then Joab went to the king and said, "What have you done? See, Abner came to you. Why did you let him go, so that he is already gone?"
- 25 *Thou knowest Abner the son of Ner, that he came to deceive thee, and to know thy going out and thy coming in, and to know all that thou doest.* You know that Abner the son of Ner came to deceive you and to know your going out and your coming in, and to know all that you are doing."
- 26 *And when Joab was come out from David, he sent messengers after Abner, which brought him again from the well of Sirah: but David knew it not.* When Joab came out from David's presence, he sent messengers after Abner. They brought him back from the cistern of Sirah. But David did not know about it.
- 27 *And when Abner was returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside in the gate to speak with him quietly, and smote him there under the fifth rib, that he died, for the blood of Asahel his brother.* When Abner returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside into the midst of the gate to speak with him privately, and there he struck him in the stomach so that he died, for the blood of Asahel his brother.

- 28 *And afterward when David heard it, he said, I and my kingdom are guiltless before the LORD for ever from the blood of Abner the son of Ner:* Afterward, when David heard of it, he said, "I and my kingdom are forever guiltless before the LORD for the blood of Abner the son of Ner.
- 29 *Let it rest on the head of Joab, and on all his father's house; and let there not fail from the house of Joab one that hath an issue, or that is a leper, or that leaneth on a staff, or that falleth on the sword, or that lacketh bread.* May it fall upon the head of Joab and upon all his father's house, and may the house of Joab never be without one who has a discharge or who is leprous or who holds a spindle or who falls by the sword or who lacks bread!"
- 30 *So Joab and Abishai his brother slew Abner, because he had slain their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle.* So Joab and Abishai his brother killed Abner, because He had put their brother Asahel to death in the battle at Gibeon.
- 31 *And David said to Joab, and to all the people that were with him, Rend your clothes, and gird you with sackcloth, and mourn before Abner. And king David himself followed the bier.* Then David said to Joab and to all the people who were with him, "Tear your clothes and put on sackcloth and mourn before Abner." And King David followed the bier.
- 32 *And they buried Abner in Hebron: and the king lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abner; and all the people wept.* They buried Abner at Hebron. And the king lifted up his voice and wept at the grave of Abner. All the people wept.
- 33 *And the king lamented over Abner, and said, Died Abner as a fool dieth?* The king lamented for Abner, saying, "Should Abner die as a fool dies?"
- 34 *Thy hands were not bound, nor thy feet put into fetters: as a man falleth before wicked men, so fellest thou. And all the people wept again over him.* Your hands were not bound; your feet were not fettered. As one falls before the wicked, you have fallen." And all the people wept again over him.

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| <p>35 <i>And when all the people came to cause David to eat meat while it was yet day, David sware, saying, So do God to me, and more also, if I taste bread, or ought else, till the sun be down.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And all the people took notice of it, and it pleased them: as whatsoever the king did pleased all the people.</i></p> <p>37 <i>For all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to slay Abner the son of Ner.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And the king said unto his servants, Know ye not that there is a prince and a great man fallen this day in Israel?</i></p> <p>39 <i>And I am this day weak, though anointed king; and these men the sons of Zeruiah be too hard for me: the LORD shall reward the doer of evil according to his wickedness.</i></p> | <p>Then all the people came to persuade David to eat bread while it was still day. But David swore, saying, "God do so to me and more also, if I taste bread or anything else until the sun goes down!"</p> <p>All the people took notice of it. It pleased them, as everything the king did pleased all the people.</p> <p>So all the people and all Israel understood that day that it had not been the king's will to put to death Abner the son of Ner.</p> <p>The king said to his servants, "Do you not know that a prince and a great man has fallen this day in Israel?"</p> <p>I am this day weak, though anointed king. These men, the sons of Zeruiah, are more severe than I. The LORD repay the evildoer according to His wickedness!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 14:30; 2 Sam 2:17; Prov 4:18-19; Job 8:7

v9 — 1 Sam 15:28

v14 — 1 Sam 18:27; 1 Sam 18:25

v16 — 2 Sam 16:5; 2 Sam 19:16

v18 — 1 Sam 15:28

v19 — 1 Chr 12:29

v21 — 2 Sam 3:12; 1 Kgs 11:37

v27 — 1 Kgs 2:5; 2 Sam 20:9-10

v35 — 2 Sam 12:17; 2 Sam 1:12

v39 — Ps 28:4; Ps 101:8

Chapter 4

Two of Ish-bosheth's captains, Rechab and Baanah, assassinated him in his bed and brought his head to David. David had them executed for killing an innocent man and buried Ish-bosheth's head in Abner's tomb at Hebron.

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| 1 | <i>And when Saul's son heard that Abner was dead in Hebron, his hands were feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled.</i> | When Ish-bosheth, Saul's son, heard that Abner had died at Hebron, his courage failed. All Israel was dismayed. |
| 2 | <i>And Saul's son had two men that were captains of bands: the name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon a Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin: (for Beeroth also was reckoned to Benjamin:</i> | Now Saul's son had two men who were commanders of raiding bands; the name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, sons of Rimmon a man of Benjamin from Beeroth (for Beeroth also is counted part of Benjamin; |
| 3 | <i>And the Beerothites fled to Gittaim, and were sojourners there until this day.)</i> | The Beerothites fled to Gittaim and have been sojourners there to this day). |
| 4 | <i>And Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son that was lame of his feet. He was five years old when the tidings came of Saul and Jonathan out of Jezreel, and his nurse took him up, and fled: and it came to pass, as she made haste to flee, that he fell, and became lame. And his name was Mephibosheth.</i> | Jonathan, the son of Saul, had a son who was crippled in his feet. He was five years old when the news about Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel. His nurse took him up and fled, and as she fled in her haste, he fell and became lame. And his name was Mephibosheth. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mephibosheth** (meh-FIB-oh-sheth) — "exterminator of shame" — Jonathan's son, lame in both feet from a childhood fall. David showed him kindness for Jonathan's sake, restoring Saul's land to him and giving him a permanent place at the king's table — a picture of God's grace to the undeserving.

- 5 *And the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, went, and came about the heat of the day to the house of Ishbosheth, who lay on a bed at noon.* Now the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, set out, and about the heat of the day they came to the house of Ish-bosheth as he was taking his midday rest.
- 6 *And they came thither into the midst of the house, as though they would have fetched wheat; and they smote him under the fifth rib: and Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped.* They came into the midst of the house as if to get wheat. They stabbed him in the stomach. Then Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped.
- 7 *For when they came into the house, he lay on his bed in his bedchamber, and they smote him, and slew him, and beheaded him, and took his head, and gat them away through the plain all night.* When they came into the house, as he lay on his bed in his bedroom, they struck him and put him to death and beheaded him. They took his head and went by the way of the Arabah all night,
- 8 *And they brought the head of Ishbosheth unto David to Hebron, and said to the king, Behold the head of Ishbosheth the son of Saul thine enemy, which sought thy life; and the LORD hath avenged my lord the king this day of Saul, and of his seed.* Brought the head of Ish-bosheth to David at Hebron. And they said to the king, "Here is the head of Ish-bosheth, the son of Saul, your enemy, who sought your life. The LORD has given my lord the king vengeance this day on Saul and on his seed."
- 9 *And David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, and said unto them, As the LORD liveth, who hath redeemed my soul out of all adversity,* But David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, "As the LORD lives, who has redeemed my life out of every adversity,
- 10 *When one told me, saying, Behold, Saul is dead, thinking to have brought good tidings, I took hold of him, and slew him in Ziklag, who thought that I would have given him a reward for his tidings:* When one told me, 'See, Saul is dead,' and thought he was bringing good news, I seized him and killed him at Ziklag, which was the reward I gave him for his news.

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| <p>11 <i>How much more, when wicked men have slain a righteous person in his own house upon his bed? shall I not therefore now require his blood of your hand, and take you away from the earth?</i></p> <p>12 <i>And David commanded his young men, and they slew them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up over the pool in Hebron. But they took the head of Ishbosheth, and buried it in the sepulchre of Abner in Hebron.</i></p> | <p>How much more, when wicked men have killed a righteous man in his own house on his bed, shall I not now require his blood at your hand and destroy you from the earth?"</p> <p>David commanded his young men. They killed them and cut off their hands and feet and hanged them beside the pool at Hebron. But they took the head of Ish-bosheth and buried it in the tomb of Abner at Hebron.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Mephibosheth (*meh-FIB-oh-sheth*) — Jonathan's crippled son who was shown kindness by David for his father's sake — brought to Jerusalem and given a seat at the king's table; his name means 'exterminating shame.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezra 4:4
 v2 — Josh 18:25
 v3 — Neh 11:33
 v4 — 2 Sam 9:3
 v6 — 2 Sam 2:23
 v9 — Ps 34:6-7; 1 Kgs 1:29; Gen 48:16; Ps 107:2; Ps 34:17

Chapter 5

All the tribes of Israel came to Hebron and anointed David king over all Israel. David captured the Jebusite stronghold of Jerusalem and made it his capital, and he defeated the Philistines twice in the Valley of Rephaim.

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| <p>1 <i>Then came all the tribes of Israel to David unto Hebron, and spake, saying, Behold, we are thy bone and thy flesh.</i></p> | <p>Then all the tribes of Israel came to David at Hebron and said, "See, we are your bone and flesh.</p> |
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- 2 *Also in time past, when Saul was king over us, thou wast he that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and the LORD said to thee, Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be a captain over Israel.* In times past, when Saul was king over us, it was you who led out and brought in Israel. And the LORD said to You, 'You shall be shepherd of my people Israel, and You shall be prince over Israel.' "
- 3 *So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and king David made a league with them in Hebron before the LORD: and they anointed David king over Israel.* So all the elders of Israel came to the king at Hebron, and King David made a covenant with them at Hebron before the LORD. They anointed David king over Israel.
- 4 *David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years.* David was thirty years old when he began to reign. He reigned forty years.
- 5 *In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years over all Israel and Judah.* At Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months, and at Jerusalem he reigned over all Israel and Judah thirty-three years.
- 6 *And the king and his men went to Jerusalem unto the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land: which spake unto David, saying, Except thou take away the blind and the lame, thou shalt not come in hither: thinking, David cannot come in hither.* The king and his men went to Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land, who said to David, "You will not come in here, but the blind and the lame will ward you off"—thinking, "David cannot come in here."
- 7 *Nevertheless David took the strong hold of Zion: the same is the city of David.* Nevertheless, David took the stronghold of Zion, that is, the city of David.

- 8 *And David said on that day, Whosoever getteth up to the gutter, and smiteth the Jebusites, and the lame and the blind, that are hated of David's soul, he shall be chief and captain. Wherefore they said, The blind and the lame shall not come into the house.* David said on that day, "Whoever would strike the Jebusites, let him get up the water shaft to attack 'the lame and the blind,' who are hated by David's soul." Therefore it is said, "The blind and the lame shall not come into the house."
- 9 *So David dwelt in the fort, and called it the city of David. And David built round about from Millo and inward.* David lived in the stronghold and called it the city of David. And David built the city all around from the Millo inward.
- 10 *And David went on, and grew great, and the LORD God of hosts was with him.* David became greater and greater, for the LORD, the God of hosts, was with Him.
- 11 *And Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and carpenters, and masons: and they built David an house.* Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and also carpenters and masons who built David a house.
- 12 *And David perceived that the LORD had established him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom for his people Israel's sake.* David knew that the LORD had established Him king over Israel, and that He had exalted His kingdom for the sake of His people Israel.
- 13 *And David took him more concubines and wives out of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron: and there were yet sons and daughters born to David.* David took more concubines and wives from Jerusalem, after he came from Hebron, and more sons and daughters were born to David.
- 14 *And these be the names of those that were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shammua, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon,* These are the names of those who were born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
- 15 *Ibhar also, and Elishua, and Nepheg, and Japhia,* Ibhar, Elishua, Nepheg, Japhia,

- 16 *And Elishama, and Eliada, and Eliphalet.* Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet.
- 17 *But when the Philistines heard that they had anointed David king over Israel, all the Philistines came up to seek David; and David heard of it, and went down to the hold.* When the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over Israel, all the Philistines went up to search for David. But David heard of it and went down to the stronghold.
- 18 *The Philistines also came and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.* Now the Philistines had come and spread out in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 19 *And David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up to the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto David, Go up: for I will doubtless deliver the Philistines into thine hand.* David inquired of the LORD, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will you give them into my hand?" And the LORD said to David, "Go up, for I will certainly give the Philistines into your hand."
- 20 *And David came to Baalperazim, and David smote them there, and said, The LORD hath broken forth upon mine enemies before me, as the breach of waters. Therefore he called the name of that place Baalperazim.* David came to Baal-perazim, and David defeated them there. And he said, "The LORD has broken through my enemies before me like a breaking flood." Therefore the name of that place is called Baal-perazim.
- 21 *And there they left their images, and David and his men burned them.* The Philistines left their idols there, and David and his men burned them.
- 22 *And the Philistines came up yet again, and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.* The Philistines came up yet again and spread out in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 23 *And when David enquired of the LORD, he said, Thou shalt not go up; but fetch a compass behind them, and come upon them over against the mulberry trees.* When David inquired of the LORD, He said, "You shall not go up; go around to their rear, and come against them opposite the balsam trees.

- 24 *And let it be, when thou hearest the sound of a going in the tops of the mulberry trees, that then thou shalt bestir thyself: for then shall the LORD go out before thee, to smite the host of the Philistines.* When You hear the sound of marching in the tops of the balsam trees, then rouse Yourself, for then the LORD has gone out before You to strike down the army of the Philistines."
- 25 *And David did so, as the LORD had commanded him; and smote the Philistines from Geba until thou come to Gazer.* David did as the LORD commanded Him, and struck down the Philistines from Geba to Gezer.

Words in this chapter:

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 11:1-3
v2 — Matt 2:6; Mic 5:4; Ezek 34:23; Ezek 37:24-25; John 10:11
v3 — 2 Sam 2:4; 1 Sam 16:13
v5 — 2 Sam 2:11
v9 — 1 Kgs 9:15; 1 Kgs 9:24
v10 — 2 Sam 3:1; Ps 46:11; Rom 8:31
v11 — 1 Chr 14:1
v12 — 2 Sam 7:16; 1 Kgs 10:9
v17 — 2 Sam 23:14; 1 Chr 11:16; 1 Chr 14:8-9; Ps 2:1-5
v19 — 2 Sam 2:1; 1 Sam 23:2; 2 Sam 5:23; Prov 3:6; Judg 20:28
v20 — Isa 28:21
v24 — 2 Kgs 7:6; Judg 4:14; Judg 7:15

Chapter 6

David brought the ark of God toward Jerusalem, but Uzzah was struck dead for touching it, and David left the ark at the house of Obed-edom. Three months later David brought the ark into Jerusalem with dancing and celebration; Michal despised him and was left childless.

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| 1 | <i>Again, David gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand.</i> | David again gathered all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand. |
| 2 | <i>And David arose, and went with all the people that were with him from Baale of Judah, to bring up from thence the ark of God, whose name is called by the name of the LORD of hosts that dwelleth between the cherubims.</i> | David arose and went with all the people who were with him from Baale-judah to bring up from there the ark of God, which is called by the name of the LORD of hosts who sits enthroned on the cherubim. |
| 3 | <i>And they set the ark of God upon a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in Gibeah: and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drave the new cart.</i> | They carried the ark of God on a new cart and brought it out of the house of Abinadab, which was on the hill. And Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, were driving the new cart. |
| 4 | <i>And they brought it out of the house of Abinadab which was at Gibeah, accompanying the ark of God: and Ahio went before the ark.</i> | They brought it out of the house of Abinadab, which was on the hill, with the ark of God, and Ahio went before the ark. |
| 5 | <i>And David and all the house of Israel played before the LORD on all manner of instruments made of fir wood, even on harps, and on psalteries, and on timbrels, and on cornets, and on cymbals.</i> | David and all the house of Israel were celebrating before the LORD, with songs and lyres and harps and tambourines and castanets and cymbals. |
| 6 | <i>And when they came to Nachon's threshingfloor, Uzzah put forth his hand to the ark of God, and took hold of it; for the oxen shook it.</i> | When they came to the threshing floor of Nacon, Uzzah put out His hand to the ark of God and took hold of it, for the oxen stumbled. |
| 7 | <i>And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzzah; and God smote him there for his error; and there he died by the ark of God.</i> | The anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzzah. God struck Him down there because of His error. He died there beside the ark of God. |

- 8 *And David was displeased, because the LORD had made a breach upon Uzzah: and he called the name of the place Perezuzzah to this day.* David was angry because the LORD had broken out against Uzzah. And that place is called Perez-uzzah to this day.
- 9 *And David was afraid of the LORD that day, and said, How shall the ark of the LORD come to me?* David was afraid of the LORD that day. He said, "How can the ark of the LORD come to me?"
- 10 *So David would not remove the ark of the LORD unto him into the city of David: but David carried it aside into the house of Obededom the Gittite.* So David was not willing to take the ark of the LORD into the city of David. But David took it aside to the house of Obed-edom the Gittite.
- 11 *And the ark of the LORD continued in the house of Obededom the Gittite three months: and the LORD blessed Obededom, and all his household.* The ark of the LORD remained in the house of Obed-edom the Gittite three months. The LORD blessed Obed-edom and all his household.
- 12 *And it was told king David, saying, The LORD hath blessed the house of Obededom, and all that pertaineth unto him, because of the ark of God. So David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obededom into the city of David with gladness.* It was told King David, "The LORD has blessed the household of Obed-edom and all that belongs to Him, because of the ark of God." So David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obed-edom to the city of David with rejoicing.
- 13 *And it was so, that when they that bare the ark of the LORD had gone six paces, he sacrificed oxen and fatlings.* When those who bore the ark of the LORD had gone six steps, He sacrificed an ox and a fattened animal.
- 14 *And David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod.* David danced before the LORD with all His might. And David was wearing a linen ephod.
- 15 *So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.* So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouting and with the sound of the horn.

- 16 *And as the ark of the LORD came into the city of David, Michal Saul's daughter looked through a window, and saw king David leaping and dancing before the LORD; and she despised him in her heart.* As the ark of the LORD came into the city of David, Michal the daughter of Saul looked out of the window and saw King David leaping and dancing before the LORD. She despised Him in her heart.
- 17 *And they brought in the ark of the LORD, and set it in his place, in the midst of the tabernacle that David had pitched for it: and David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.* They brought in the ark of the LORD and set it in its place, inside the tent that David had pitched for it. And David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.
- 18 *And as soon as David had made an end of offering burnt offerings and peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD of hosts.* When David had finished offering the burnt offerings and the peace offerings, He blessed the people in the name of the LORD of hosts
- 19 *And he dealt among all the people, even among the whole multitude of Israel, as well to the women as men, to every one a cake of bread, and a good piece of flesh, and a flagon of wine. So all the people departed every one to his house.* Distributed among all the people, the whole crowd of Israel, both men and women, a loaf of bread, a portion of meat, and a cake of raisins to each one. Then all the people departed, each to his house.
- 20 *Then David returned to bless his household. And Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and said, How glorious was the king of Israel to day, who uncovered himself to day in the eyes of the handmaids of his servants, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovereth himself!* David returned to bless his household. But Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David and said, "How the king of Israel honored himself today, uncovering himself today before the eyes of his servants' female servants, as one of the vulgar fellows shamelessly uncovers himself!"

- 21 *And David said unto Michal, It was before the LORD, which chose me before thy father, and before all his house, to appoint me ruler over the people of the LORD, over Israel: therefore will I play before the LORD.* David said to Michal, "It was before the LORD, Who chose me above Your father and above all His house, to appoint me as prince over Israel, the people of the LORD—and I will celebrate before the LORD.
- 22 *And I will yet be more vile than thus, and will be base in mine own sight: and of the maidservants which thou hast spoken of, of them shall I be had in honour.* I will make myself yet more contemptible than this. I will be abased in Your eyes. But by the female servants of whom You have spoken, by them I shall be held in honor."
- 23 *Therefore Michal the daughter of Saul had no child unto the day of her death.* Michal the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Sam 4:4; 1 Sam 7:1; Ps 80:1; 1 Chr 13:5-6; Ex 25:18-22

v3 — 1 Sam 6:7

v5 — 1 Chr 13:8; Ps 150:3-5

v6 — Num 4:15; 1 Chr 13:9; Num 4:19-20

v7 — 1 Sam 6:19; 1 Chr 15:13

v11 — Gen 39:5; Gen 30:27; Prov 3:9-10; Mal 3:10

v13 — 1 Kgs 8:5; 1 Chr 15:15; Num 4:15

v14 — 1 Sam 2:18; Ex 15:20; Ps 150:4; Ps 149:3; Judg 11:34

v16 — 1 Cor 2:14; 1 Chr 15:29; 2 Sam 3:14; Acts 2:13; Ps 69:7

v17 — 2 Chr 1:4; 1 Chr 15:1

v20 — 2 Sam 6:16; 2 Sam 6:14; Judg 9:4

v21 — Acts 13:22; 2 Sam 6:16; 1 Sam 13:14; Ps 89:19-20; Ps 78:70-72

Chapter 7

David desired to build a house for the LORD, but God sent Nathan the prophet to tell him that his son would build the temple. The LORD made a covenant with David, promising that his throne would be established forever.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, when the king sat in his house, and the LORD had given him rest round about from all his enemies;</i> | Now when the king lived in his house and the LORD had given Him rest from all His surrounding enemies, |
| 2 | <i>That the king said unto Nathan the prophet, See now, I dwell in an house of cedar, but the ark of God dwelleth within curtains.</i> | The king said to Nathan the prophet, "See now, I dwell in a house of cedar, but the ark of God dwells in a tent." |
| 3 | <i>And Nathan said to the king, Go, do all that is in thine heart; for the LORD is with thee.</i> | Nathan said to the king, "Go, do all that is in your heart, for the LORD is with You." |
| 4 | <i>And it came to pass that night, that the word of the LORD came unto Nathan, saying,</i> | But that same night the word of the LORD came to Nathan, |
| 5 | <i>Go and tell my servant David, Thus saith the LORD, Shalt thou build me an house for me to dwell in?</i> | "Go and tell my servant David, "Thus says the LORD: Would You build me a house to dwell in? |
| 6 | <i>Whereas I have not dwelt in any house since the time that I brought up the children of Israel out of Egypt, even to this day, but have walked in a tent and in a tabernacle.</i> | I have not lived in a house since the day I brought up the people of Israel from Egypt to this day. But I have been moving about in a tent for my dwelling. |

- 7 *In all the places wherein I have walked with all the children of Israel spake I a word with any of the tribes of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people Israel, saying, Why build ye not me an house of cedar?* In all places where I have moved with all the people of Israel, did I speak a word with any of the tribes of Israel, whom I commanded to shepherd my people Israel, saying, "Why have You not built me a house of cedar?"
- 8 *Now therefore so shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheecote, from following the sheep, to be ruler over my people, over Israel:* Now, therefore, thus You shall say to my servant David, "Thus says the LORD of hosts, I took You from the pasture, from following the sheep, that You should be prince over my people Israel.
- 9 *And I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight, and have made thee a great name, like unto the name of the great men that are in the earth.* I have been with You wherever You went and have cut off all Your enemies from before You. And I will make for You a great name, like the name of the great ones of the earth.
- 10 *Moreover I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in a place of their own, and move no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as beforetime,* I will appoint a place for my people Israel and will plant them, so that they may dwell in their own place and be disturbed no more. And violent men shall afflict them no more, as formerly,
- 11 *And as since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel, and have caused thee to rest from all thine enemies. Also the LORD telleth thee that he will make thee an house.* From the time that I appointed judges over my people Israel. And I will give You rest from all Your enemies. Moreover, the LORD declares to You that the LORD will make You a house.
- 12 *And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom.* When Your days are fulfilled and You lie down with Your fathers, I will raise up Your seed after You, who shall come from Your body. I will establish His kingdom.

- 13 *He shall build an house for my name, and I will stablish the throne of his kingdom for ever.* He shall build a house for my name. I will establish the throne of His kingdom forever.
- 14 *I will be his father, and he shall be my son. If he commit iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men:* I will be to Him a father. He shall be to me a son. If He commit iniquity, I will discipline Him with the rod of men, with the stripes of the sons of men,
- 15 *But my mercy shall not depart away from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before thee.* But my mercy will not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away from before you.
- 16 *And thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever before thee: thy throne shall be established for ever.* Your house and your kingdom shall be made sure forever before you. Your throne shall be established forever.' "
- 17 *According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak unto David.* In accordance with all these words, and in accordance with all this vision, Nathan spoke to David.
- 18 *Then went king David in, and sat before the LORD, and he said, Who am I, O Lord GOD? and what is my house, that thou hast brought me hitherto?* Then King David went in and sat before the LORD and said, "Who am I, O Lord GOD, and what is my house, that You have brought me thus far?
- 19 *And this was yet a small thing in thy sight, O Lord GOD; but thou hast spoken also of thy servant's house for a great while to come. And is this the manner of man, O Lord GOD?* Yet this was a small thing in Your eyes, O Lord GOD. You have spoken also of Your servant's house for a great while to come, and is this the manner of man, O Lord GOD!
- 20 *And what can David say more unto thee? for thou, Lord GOD, knowest thy servant.* What more can David say to you? For you know your servant, O Lord GOD!
- 21 *For thy word's sake, and according to thine own heart, hast thou done all these great things, to make thy servant know them.* Because of Your promise, and according to Your own heart, You have brought about all this greatness, to make Your servant know it.

- 22 *Wherefore thou art great, O LORD God: for there is none like thee, neither is there any God beside thee, according to all that we have heard with our ears.* Therefore You are great, O LORD God. For there is none like You, and there is no God besides You, according to all that we have heard with our ears.
- 23 *And what one nation in the earth is like thy people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem for a people to himself, and to make him a name, and to do for you great things and terrible, for thy land, before thy people, which thou redeemedst to thee from Egypt, from the nations and their gods?* Who is like Your people Israel, the one nation on earth whom God went to redeem to be His people, making Himself a name and doing for them great and awesome things by driving out before Your people, whom You redeemed for Yourself from Egypt, a nation and its gods?
- 24 *For thou hast confirmed to thyself thy people Israel to be a people unto thee for ever: and thou, LORD, art become their God.* You established for Yourself Your people Israel to be Your people forever. And You, O LORD, became their God.
- 25 *And now, O LORD God, the word that thou hast spoken concerning thy servant, and concerning his house, establish it for ever, and do as thou hast said.* Now, O LORD God, confirm forever the word that You have spoken concerning Your servant and concerning His house, and do as You have spoken.
- 26 *And let thy name be magnified for ever, saying, The LORD of hosts is the God over Israel: and let the house of thy servant David be established before thee.* Your name will be magnified forever, saying, 'The LORD of hosts is God over Israel,' and the house of Your servant David will be established before you.
- 27 *For thou, O LORD of hosts, God of Israel, hast revealed to thy servant, saying, I will build thee an house: therefore hath thy servant found in his heart to pray this prayer unto thee.* For You, O LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, have made this revelation to Your servant, saying, 'I will build You a house.' Therefore Your servant has found courage to pray this prayer to You.

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| <p>28 <i>And now, O Lord GOD, thou art that God, and thy words be true, and thou hast promised this goodness unto thy servant:</i></p> <p>29 <i>Therefore now let it please thee to bless the house of thy servant, that it may continue for ever before thee: for thou, O Lord GOD, hast spoken it: and with thy blessing let the house of thy servant be blessed for ever.</i></p> | <p>Now, O Lord GOD, You are God, and Your words are true, and You have promised this good thing to Your servant.</p> <p>Now therefore may it please You to bless the house of Your servant, so that it may continue forever before You. For You, O Lord GOD, have spoken, and with Your blessing shall the house of Your servant be blessed forever."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Saul (SAWL) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v8** — 2 Sam 6:21; 1 Sam 16:11-12; Ps 78:70-71; 1 Chr 17:7; 2 Sam 12:7
- v9** — 2 Sam 5:10; 1 Chr 17:8; 1 Sam 18:14; 2 Sam 8:6; Ps 18:37-42
- v10** — Amos 9:15; 1 Chr 17:9; Jer 24:6; Isa 60:18; Ezek 37:25-27
- v11** — 2 Sam 7:27; 2 Sam 7:1; 1 Sam 12:9-11; 1 Chr 17:10; Ps 89:3-4
- v12** — Acts 2:30; 1 Kgs 8:20; 1 Kgs 2:1; Acts 13:36; Ps 132:11-12
- v13** — Luke 1:31-33; 1 Kgs 8:19; 2 Sam 7:16; 1 Chr 22:9-10; Ps 89:4
- v14** — Heb 1:5; Rev 3:19; 1 Chr 17:13; 1 Chr 28:6; Deut 8:5
- v16** — Luke 1:32-33; Ps 89:36-37; 2 Sam 7:13; Isa 9:7; Dan 2:44
- v18** — Ps 8:4; 1 Chr 17:16; 1 Sam 18:18; Gen 32:10; Ex 3:11
- v22** — Ps 86:10; Ex 15:11; Ps 86:8; Mic 7:18; 1 Chr 16:25
- v23** — Deut 10:21; Deut 9:26; Ps 111:9; Deut 15:15; Neh 1:10
- v29** — 1 Chr 17:27; Num 6:24-26; Ps 115:12-15; 2 Sam 22:51

Chapter 8

David defeated the Philistines, Moabites, the king of Zobah, the Syrians, and the Edomites, extending his kingdom in every direction. The LORD gave David victory wherever he went, and David administered justice over all Israel.

- 1 *And after this it came to pass, that David smote the Philistines, and subdued them: and David took Methegammah out of the hand of the Philistines.* After this David defeated the Philistines and subdued them, and David took Metheg-ammah out of the hand of the Philistines.
- 2 *And he smote Moab, and measured them with a line, casting them down to the ground; even with two lines measured he to put to death, and with one full line to keep alive. And so the Moabites became David's servants, and brought gifts.* He defeated Moab and he measured them with a line, making them lie down on the ground. Two lines he measured to be put to death, and one full line to be spared. And the Moabites became servants to David and brought tribute.
- 3 *David smote also Hadadezer, the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to recover his border at the river Euphrates.* David also defeated Hadadezer the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to restore his power at the river Euphrates.
- 4 *And David took from him a thousand chariots, and seven hundred horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen: and David houghed all the chariot horses, but reserved of them for an hundred chariots.* David took from him a thousand chariots, and seven hundred horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen. And David hamstrung all the chariot horses but left enough for a hundred chariots.
- 5 *And when the Syrians of Damascus came to succour Hadadezer king of Zobah, David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men.* When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck down 22,000 men of the Syrians.
- 6 *Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus: and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought gifts. And the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.* Then David put garrisons in Aram of Damascus, and the Syrians became servants to David and brought tribute. And the LORD gave victory to David wherever he went.
- 7 *And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.* David took the shields of gold that were carried by the servants of Hadadezer and brought them to Jerusalem.

- 8 *And from Betah, and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, king David took exceeding much brass.* From Betah and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, King David took very much bronze.
- 9 *When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had smitten all the host of Hadadezer,* When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had defeated the whole army of Hadadezer,
- 10 *Then Toi sent Joram his son unto king David, to salute him, and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer, and smitten him: for Hadadezer had wars with Toi. And Joram brought with him vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and vessels of brass:* Toi sent his son Joram to King David, to ask about his health and to bless him because he had fought against Hadadezer and defeated him, for Hadadezer had often been at war with Toi. And Joram brought with him articles of silver, gold, and bronze.
- 11 *Which also king David did dedicate unto the LORD, with the silver and gold that he had dedicated of all nations which he subdued;* These also King David dedicated to the LORD, together with the silver and gold that He dedicated from all the nations he subdued—
- 12 *Of Syria, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalek, and of the spoil of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah.* From Syria, Moab, the Ammonites, the Philistines, Amalek, and from the spoil of Hadadezer the son of Rehob, king of Zobah.
- 13 *And David gat him a name when he returned from smiting of the Syrians in the valley of salt, being eighteen thousand men.* David made a name for himself when he returned from striking down 18,000 Edomites in the Valley of Salt.
- 14 *And he put garrisons in Edom; throughout all Edom put he garrisons, and all they of Edom became David's servants. And the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.* Then He put garrisons in Edom; throughout all Edom He put garrisons. All the Edomites became David's servants. And the LORD gave victory to David wherever he went.
- 15 *And David reigned over all Israel; and David executed judgment and justice unto all his people.* So David reigned over all Israel. And David administered justice and equity to all his people.

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| 16 | <i>And Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the host; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder;</i> | Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army, and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder, |
| 17 | <i>And Zadok the son of Ahitub, and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, were the priests; and Seraiah was the scribe;</i> | Zadok the son of Ahitub and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar were priests, and Seraiah was secretary, |
| 18 | <i>And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over both the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were chief rulers.</i> | Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites, and David's sons were chief rulers. |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 18:1-17
- v2 — Num 24:17
- v3 — 1 Sam 14:47
- v6 — 2 Sam 8:14
- v11 — 1 Kgs 7:51
- v12 — 2 Sam 10:14
- v13 — 2 Kgs 14:7
- v15 — Amos 5:15
- v16 — 1 Kgs 4:3
- v18 — 1 Sam 30:14

Chapter 9

David sought out any remaining member of Saul's house to show kindness for Jonathan's sake. He found Mephibosheth, Jonathan's crippled son, restored all of Saul's land to him, and gave him a permanent place at the king's table.

- 1 *And David said, Is there yet any that is left of the house of Saul, that I may shew him kindness for Jonathan's sake?*

David said, "Is there still anyone left of the house of Saul, that I may show him kindness for Jonathan's sake?"
- 2 *And there was of the house of Saul a servant whose name was Ziba. And when they had called him unto David, the king said unto him, Art thou Ziba? And he said, Thy servant is he.*

Now there was a servant of the house of Saul whose name was Ziba. And when they called him to David, the king said to him, "Are you Ziba?" And he said, "I am your servant."
- 3 *And the king said, Is there not yet any of the house of Saul, that I may shew the kindness of God unto him? And Ziba said unto the king, Jonathan hath yet a son, which is lame on his feet.*

The king said, "Is there not still someone of the house of Saul, that I may show the kindness of God to him?" Ziba said to the king, "There is still a son of Jonathan; he is crippled in his feet."
- 4 *And the king said unto him, Where is he? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he is in the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, in Lodebar.*

The king said to him, "Where is he?" And Ziba said to the king, "He is in the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, at Lodebar."
- 5 *Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, from Lodebar.*

Then King David sent and brought him from the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, from Lodebar.
- 6 *Now when Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, was come unto David, he fell on his face, and did reverence. And David said, Mephibosheth. And he answered, Behold thy servant!*

Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan, son of Saul, came to David and fell on his face and paid homage. And David said, "Mephibosheth!" And he answered, "Here is your servant."

- 7 *And David said unto him, Fear not: for I will surely shew thee kindness for Jonathan thy father's sake, and will restore thee all the land of Saul thy father; and thou shalt eat bread at my table continually.* David said to him, "Do not be afraid, for I will show you kindness for the sake of your father Jonathan. I will restore to you all the land of Saul your father, and you shall eat at my table always."
- 8 *And he bowed himself, and said, What is thy servant, that thou shouldest look upon such a dead dog as I am?* He paid homage and said, "What is your servant, that you should show regard for a dead dog such as I?"
- 9 *Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said unto him, I have given unto thy master's son all that pertained to Saul and to all his house.* Then the king called Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "All that belonged to Saul and to all his house I have given to your master's son.
- 10 *Thou therefore, and thy sons, and thy servants, shall till the land for him, and thou shalt bring in the fruits, that thy master's son may have food to eat: but Mephibosheth thy master's son shall eat bread alway at my table. Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.* You and your sons and your servants shall till the land for him and shall bring in the produce, that your master's son may have bread to eat. But Mephibosheth your master's son shall always eat at my table." Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.
- 11 *Then said Ziba unto the king, According to all that my lord the king hath commanded his servant, so shall thy servant do. As for Mephibosheth, said the king, he shall eat at my table, as one of the king's sons.* Then Ziba said to the king, "According to all that my lord the king commands his servant, so will your servant do." So Mephibosheth ate at David's table, like one of the king's sons.
- 12 *And Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was Micha: and all that dwelt in the house of Ziba were servants unto Mephibosheth.* Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was Mica. And all who lived in Ziba's house became Mephibosheth's servants.
- 13 *So Mephibosheth dwelt in Jerusalem: for he did eat continually at the king's table; and was lame on both his feet.* So Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, for he always ate at the king's table. Now he was lame in both his feet.

Words in this chapter:

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Mephibosheth (*meh-FIB-oh-sheth*) — Jonathan's crippled son who was shown kindness by David for his father's sake — brought to Jerusalem and given a seat at the king's table; his name means 'exterminating shame.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Sam 20:42; Mark 9:41; Matt 25:40; 1 Pet 3:8; 2 Sam 1:26

v2 — 2 Sam 16:1-4; 2 Sam 19:17

v3 — 2 Sam 4:4; Titus 3:3-4

v4 — 2 Sam 17:27-29

v6 — 2 Sam 16:4; 1 Chr 9:40

v7 — 2 Sam 9:1; 2 Sam 19:28; 2 Sam 9:3; 1 Kgs 2:7; Luke 1:29-30

v8 — 2 Sam 16:9; Matt 15:26-27

v10 — 2 Sam 9:7; 2 Sam 19:28

v13 — 2 Sam 9:7

Chapter 10

David sent envoys to comfort the new king of Ammon, but they were humiliated by having their beards half shaved and garments cut. The Ammonites hired Syrian mercenaries, but Joab and Abishai defeated both the Ammonites and the Syrians.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass after this, that the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>After this the king of the Ammonites died, and Hanun his son reigned in his place.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then said David, I will shew kindness unto Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father shewed kindness unto me. And David sent to comfort him by the hand of his servants for his father. And David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon.</i></p> | <p>David said, "I will deal loyally with Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father dealt loyally with me." So David sent by his servants to console him concerning his father. And David's servants came into the land of the Ammonites.</p> |

- 3 *And the princes of the children of Ammon said unto Hanun their lord, Thinkest thou that David doth honour thy father, that he hath sent comforters unto thee? hath not David rather sent his servants unto thee, to search the city, and to spy it out, and to overthrow it?* But the princes of the Ammonites said to Hanun their lord, "Do you think, because David has sent comforters to you, that he is honoring your father? Has not David sent his servants to you to search the city and to spy it out and to overthrow it?"
- 4 *Wherefore Hanun took David's servants, and shaved off the one half of their beards, and cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away.* So Hanun took David's servants and shaved off half the beard of each and cut off their garments in the middle, at their hips, and sent them away.
- 5 *When they told it unto David, he sent to meet them, because the men were greatly ashamed: and the king said, Tarry at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return.* When it was told David, he sent to meet them, for the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, "Remain at Jericho until your beards have grown and then return."
- 6 *And when the children of Ammon saw that they stank before David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the Syrians of Bethrehab, and the Syrians of Zoba, twenty thousand footmen, and of king Maacah a thousand men, and of Ishtob twelve thousand men.* When the Ammonites saw that they had become a stench to David, the Ammonites sent and hired the Syrians of Beth-rehab and the Syrians of Zobah, 20,000 foot soldiers, and the king of Maacah with 1,000 men, and the men of Tob, 12,000 men.
- 7 *And when David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the host of the mighty men.* When David heard of it, he sent Joab and all the army of the mighty men.
- 8 *And the children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entering in of the gate: and the Syrians of Zoba, and of Rehob, and Ishtob, and Maacah, were by themselves in the field.* The Ammonites came out and drew up in battle array at the entrance of the gate, and the Syrians of Zobah and of Rehob and the men of Tob and Maacah were by themselves in the open country.

- 9 *When Joab saw that the front of the battle was against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians:* When Joab saw that the battle was set against him both in front and in the rear, he chose some of the best men of Israel and arrayed them against the Syrians.
- 10 *And the rest of the people he delivered into the hand of Abishai his brother, that he might put them in array against the children of Ammon.* The rest of his men he put in the charge of Abishai his brother. He arrayed them against the Ammonites.
- 11 *And he said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then thou shalt help me: but if the children of Ammon be too strong for thee, then I will come and help thee.* He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you shall help me, but if the Ammonites are too strong for you, then I will come and help you.
- 12 *Be of good courage, and let us play the men for our people, and for the cities of our God: and the LORD do that which seemeth him good.* Be strong, and let us be courageous for the sake of our people, and for the cities of our God, and may the LORD do what seems good to Him."
- 13 *And Joab drew nigh, and the people that were with him, unto the battle against the Syrians: and they fled before him.* So Joab and the people who were with him drew near to battle against the Syrians. They fled before Him.
- 14 *And when the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were fled, then fled they also before Abishai, and entered into the city. So Joab returned from the children of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem.* When the Ammonites saw that the Syrians fled, they likewise fled before Abishai and entered the city. Then Joab returned from fighting against the Ammonites and came to Jerusalem.
- 15 *And when the Syrians saw that they were smitten before Israel, they gathered themselves together.* But when the Syrians saw that they had been defeated before Israel, they gathered themselves together.

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| <p>16 <i>And Hadarezer sent, and brought out the Syrians that were beyond the river: and they came to Helam; and Shobach the captain of the host of Hadarezer went before them.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And when it was told David, he gathered all Israel together, and passed over Jordan, and came to Helam. And the Syrians set themselves in array against David, and fought with him.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the Syrians fled before Israel; and David slew the men of seven hundred chariots of the Syrians, and forty thousand horsemen, and smote Shobach the captain of their host, who died there.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And when all the kings that were servants to Hadarezer saw that they were smitten before Israel, they made peace with Israel, and served them. So the Syrians feared to help the children of Ammon any more.</i></p> | <p>Hadarezer sent and brought out the Syrians who were beyond the Euphrates. They came to Helam, with Shobach the commander of the army of Hadarezer at their head.</p> <p>When it was told David, he gathered all Israel together and crossed the Jordan and came to Helam. The Syrians arrayed themselves against David and fought with him.</p> <p>The Syrians fled before Israel, and David killed of the Syrians the men of 700 chariots, and 40,000 horsemen, and struck down Shobach the commander of their army, so that he died there.</p> <p>When all the kings who were servants of Hadarezer saw that they had been defeated before Israel, they made peace with Israel and became subject to them. So the Syrians were afraid to save the Ammonites anymore.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Sam 11:1

v4 — Isa 20:4

v6 — 2 Sam 8:5; 2 Sam 8:3

v12 — 1 Cor 16:13; Deut 31:6; 1 Sam 3:18; Heb 13:6; Neh 4:14

v18 — 1 Chr 19:18

v19 — 2 Sam 8:6

Chapter 11

David committed adultery with Bathsheba while her husband Uriah was at war, and she became pregnant. When David's attempts to cover the sin failed, he ordered Joab to place Uriah in the fiercest fighting, where he was killed.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, after the year was expired, at the time when kings go forth to battle, that David sent Joab, and his servants with him, and all Israel; and they destroyed the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabbah. But David tarried still at Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>In the spring of the year, the time when kings go out to battle, David sent Joab. His servants with him. All Israel. And they ravaged the Ammonites and besieged Rabbah. But David remained at Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it came to pass in an eveningtide, that David arose from off his bed, and walked upon the roof of the king's house: and from the roof he saw a woman washing herself; and the woman was very beautiful to look upon.</i></p> | <p>It happened, late one afternoon, when David arose from his couch and was walking on the roof of the king's house, that he saw from the roof a woman bathing. The woman was very beautiful.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And David sent and enquired after the woman. And one said, Is not this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite?</i></p> | <p>David sent and inquired about the woman. And one said, "Is not this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite?"</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bathsheba** (bath-SHEE-bah) — "daughter of the oath" — Wife of Uriah the Hittite, taken by David in adultery. After Uriah's death she became David's wife and bore Solomon, through whom the messianic line continued. She later secured the throne for Solomon against Adonijah's claim.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Uriah** (yoo-RY-ah) — "the LORD is my light" — A Hittite soldier in David's army, one of his mighty men, and husband of Bathsheba. David had him placed in the front line of battle to be killed, to cover his adultery. Uriah's faithfulness and integrity contrast sharply with David's treachery.

- 4 *And David sent messengers, and took her; and she came in unto him, and he lay with her; for she was purified from her uncleanness: and she returned unto her house.* So David sent messengers and took her. She came to him. He lay with her. (Now she had been purifying herself from her uncleanness.) Then she returned to her house.
- 5 *And the woman conceived, and sent and told David, and said, I am with child.* The woman conceived. She sent and told David, "I am pregnant."
- 6 *And David sent to Joab, saying, Send me Uriah the Hittite. And Joab sent Uriah to David.* So David sent word to Joab, "Send me Uriah the Hittite." And Joab sent Uriah to David.
- 7 *And when Uriah was come unto him, David demanded of him how Joab did, and how the people did, and how the war prospered.* When Uriah came to him, David asked how Joab was doing and how the people were doing and how the war was going.
- 8 *And David said to Uriah, Go down to thy house, and wash thy feet. And Uriah departed out of the king's house, and there followed him a mess of meat from the king.* Then David said to Uriah, "Go down to your house and wash your feet." And Uriah went out of the king's house, and there followed him a present from the king.
- 9 *But Uriah slept at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and went not down to his house.* But Uriah slept at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and did not go down to his house.
- 10 *And when they had told David, saying, Uriah went not down unto his house, David said unto Uriah, Camest thou not from thy journey? why then didst thou not go down unto thine house?* When they told David, "Uriah did not go down to his house," David said to Uriah, "Have you not come from a journey? Why did you not go down to your house?"

- 11 *And Uriah said unto David, The ark, and Israel, and Judah, abide in tents; and my lord Joab, and the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open fields; shall I then go into mine house, to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? as thou livest, and as thy soul liveth, I will not do this thing.* Uriah said to David, "The ark and Israel and Judah dwell in booths, and my lord Joab and the servants of my lord are camping in the open field. Shall I then go to my house, to eat and to drink and to lie with my wife? As you live, and as your soul lives, I will not do this thing."
- 12 *And David said to Uriah, Tarry here to day also, and to morrow I will let thee depart. So Uriah abode in Jerusalem that day, and the morrow.* Then David said to Uriah, "Remain here today also, and tomorrow I will send you back." So Uriah remained in Jerusalem that day and the next.
- 13 *And when David had called him, he did eat and drink before him; and he made him drunk: and at even he went out to lie on his bed with the servants of his lord, but went not down to his house.* David invited him. He ate in his presence and drank, so that he made him drunk. And in the evening he went out to lie on his couch with the servants of his lord. But he did not go down to his house.
- 14 *And it came to pass in the morning, that David wrote a letter to Joab, and sent it by the hand of Uriah.* In the morning David wrote a letter to Joab and sent it by the hand of Uriah.
- 15 *And he wrote in the letter, saying, Set ye Uriah in the forefront of the hottest battle, and retire ye from him, that he may be smitten, and die.* In the letter he wrote, "Set Uriah in the forefront of the hardest fighting, and then draw back from him, that he may be struck down and die."
- 16 *And it came to pass, when Joab observed the city, that he assigned Uriah unto a place where he knew that valiant men were.* As Joab was besieging the city, he assigned Uriah to the place where he knew there were valiant men.
- 17 *And the men of the city went out, and fought with Joab: and there fell some of the people of the servants of David; and Uriah the Hittite died also.* The men of the city came out and fought with Joab. Some of the servants of David fell. Uriah the Hittite also died.
- 18 *Then Joab sent and told David all the things concerning the war;* Then Joab sent and told David all the news about the fighting.

- 19 *And charged the messenger, saying, When thou hast made an end of telling the matters of the war unto the king,* He instructed the messenger, "When you have finished telling all the news about the fighting to the king,
- 20 *And if so be that the king's wrath arise, and he say unto thee, Wherefore approached ye so nigh unto the city when ye did fight? knew ye not that they would shoot from the wall?* Then if the king's anger rises, and if he says to you, 'Why did you go so near the city to fight? Did you not know that they would shoot from the wall?
- 21 *Who smote Abimelech the son of Jerubbesheth? did not a woman cast a piece of a millstone upon him from the wall, that he died in Thebez? why went ye nigh the wall? then say thou, Thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.* Who killed Abimelech the son of Jerubbesheth? Did not a woman cast an upper millstone on him from the wall, so that he died at Thebez? Why did you go so near the wall?' then you shall say, 'Your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.' "
- 22 *So the messenger went, and came and shewed David all that Joab had sent him for.* So the messenger went and came and told David all that Joab had sent him to tell.
- 23 *And the messenger said unto David, Surely the men prevailed against us, and came out unto us into the field, and we were upon them even unto the entering of the gate.* The messenger said to David, "The men gained an advantage over us and came out against us in the field. But we drove them back to the entrance of the gate.
- 24 *And the shooters shot from off the wall upon thy servants; and some of the king's servants be dead, and thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.* Then the archers shot at your servants from the wall. Some of the king's servants are dead, and your servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also."
- 25 *Then David said unto the messenger, Thus shalt thou say unto Joab, Let not this thing displease thee, for the sword devoureth one as well as another: make thy battle more strong against the city, and overthrow it: and encourage thou him.* David said to the messenger, "Thus shall you say to Joab, 'Do not let this matter displease you, for the sword devours now one and now another. Strengthen your attack against the city and overthrow it.' And encourage him."

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| <p>26 <i>And when the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her husband was dead, she mourned for her husband.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And when the mourning was past, David sent and fetched her to his house, and she became his wife, and bare him a son. But the thing that David had done displeased the LORD.</i></p> | <p>When the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her husband was dead, she lamented over her husband.</p> <p>When the mourning was over, David sent and brought her to his house. She became his wife and bore Him a son. But the thing that David had done displeased the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Bathsheba (*bath-SHEE-bah*) — The wife of Uriah whom David took in adultery — after Uriah's death she married David; mother of Solomon; her name means 'daughter of the oath.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 20:1; 1 Kgs 20:26; 1 Kgs 20:22
- v2 — Matt 5:28; Ps 119:37; 1 John 2:16; Job 31:1; Acts 10:9
- v3 — 2 Sam 23:39; 1 Chr 3:5
- v4 — Jas 1:14-15; Lev 18:19
- v5 — Deut 22:22
- v11 — 2 Sam 7:2
- v15 — 2 Sam 12:9
- v27 — Ps 51:4-5; 2 Sam 12:9

Chapter 12

Nathan the prophet confronted David with a parable about a rich man who stole a poor man's lamb, and David condemned himself. God declared that the sword would never depart from David's house; the child born of the adultery died, but Bathsheba later bore Solomon.

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| <p>1 <i>And the LORD sent Nathan unto David. And he came unto him, and said unto him, There were two men in one city; the one rich, and the other poor.</i></p> | <p>The LORD sent Nathan to David. He came to him and said to him, "There were two men in a certain city, the one rich and the other poor.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nathan** (NAY-than) — "he gave" — A prophet in David's court who delivered God's covenant promise to David (ch. 7) and later confronted him over his sin with Bathsheba using the parable of the poor man's lamb. His words "You are the man!" are among the most dramatic in Scripture.

- 2 *The rich man had exceeding many flocks and herds:* The rich man had very many flocks and herds,
- 3 *But the poor man had nothing, save one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up: and it grew up together with him, and with his children; it did eat of his own meat, and drank of his own cup, and lay in his bosom, and was unto him as a daughter.* But the poor man had nothing but one little ewe lamb, which he had bought. And he brought it up. It grew up with him and with his children. It used to eat of his morsel and drink from his cup and lie in his arms. It was like a daughter to him.
- 4 *And there came a traveller unto the rich man, and he spared to take of his own flock and of his own herd, to dress for the wayfaring man that was come unto him; but took the poor man's lamb, and dressed it for the man that was come to him.* Now there came a traveler to the rich man. He was unwilling to take one of his own flock or herd to prepare for the guest who had come to him. But he took the poor man's lamb and prepared it for the man who had come to him."
- 5 *And David's anger was greatly kindled against the man; and he said to Nathan, As the LORD liveth, the man that hath done this thing shall surely die:* Then David's anger was greatly kindled against the man. He said to Nathan, "As the LORD lives, the man who has done this deserves to die,
- 6 *And he shall restore the lamb fourfold, because he did this thing, and because he had no pity.* He shall restore the lamb fourfold, because He did this thing, and because He had no pity."
- 7 *And Nathan said to David, Thou art the man. Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I anointed thee king over Israel, and I delivered thee out of the hand of Saul;* Nathan said to David, "You are the man! Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, 'I anointed you king over Israel. I delivered you out of the hand of Saul.

- 8 *And I gave thee thy master's house, and thy master's wives into thy bosom, and gave thee the house of Israel and of Judah; and if that had been too little, I would moreover have given unto thee such and such things.* I gave You Your master's house and Your master's wives into Your arms and gave You the house of Israel and of Judah. And if this were too little, I would add to You as much more.
- 9 *Wherefore hast thou despised the commandment of the LORD, to do evil in his sight? thou hast killed Uriah the Hittite with the sword, and hast taken his wife to be thy wife, and hast slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon.* Why have You despised the word of the LORD, to do what is evil in His sight? You have struck down Uriah the Hittite with the sword and have taken his wife to be Your wife and have killed Him with the sword of the Ammonites.
- 10 *Now therefore the sword shall never depart from thine house; because thou hast despised me, and hast taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be thy wife.* Now therefore the sword shall never depart from Your house, because You have despised me and have taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be your wife.'
- 11 *Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will raise up evil against thee out of thine own house, and I will take thy wives before thine eyes, and give them unto thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun.* Thus says the LORD, 'I will raise up evil against You out of Your own house. And I will take Your wives before Your eyes and give them to Your neighbor. He shall lie with Your wives in the sight of this sun.
- 12 *For thou didst it secretly: but I will do this thing before all Israel, and before the sun.* For You did it secretly. But I will do this thing before all Israel and before the sun.' "
- 13 *And David said unto Nathan, I have sinned against the LORD. And Nathan said unto David, The LORD also hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die.* David said to Nathan, "I have sinned against the LORD." And Nathan said to David, "The LORD also has put away your sin; you shall not die.

- 14 *Howbeit, because by this deed thou hast given great occasion to the enemies of the LORD to blaspheme, the child also that is born unto thee shall surely die.* Nevertheless, because by this deed You have utterly scorned the LORD, the child who is born to you shall die."
- 15 *And Nathan departed unto his house. And the LORD struck the child that Uriah's wife bare unto David, and it was very sick.* Then Nathan went to his house. And the LORD afflicted the child that Uriah's wife bore to David. He became sick.
- 16 *David therefore besought God for the child; and David fasted, and went in, and lay all night upon the earth.* David therefore sought God on behalf of the child. And David fasted and went in and lay all night on the ground.
- 17 *And the elders of his house arose, and went to him, to raise him up from the earth: but he would not, neither did he eat bread with them.* The elders of his house stood beside him, to raise him from the ground. But he would not, nor did he eat food with them.
- 18 *And it came to pass on the seventh day, that the child died. And the servants of David feared to tell him that the child was dead: for they said, Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spake unto him, and he would not hearken unto our voice: how will he then vex himself, if we tell him that the child is dead?* On the seventh day the child died. And the servants of David were afraid to tell him that the child was dead, for they said, "While the child was still alive, we spoke to him. He did not listen to us. How then can we say to him the child is dead? He may do himself some harm."
- 19 *But when David saw that his servants whispered, David perceived that the child was dead: therefore David said unto his servants, Is the child dead? And they said, He is dead.* But when David saw that his servants were whispering together, David understood that the child was dead. And David said to his servants, "Is the child dead?" They said, "He is dead."

- 20 *Then David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed himself, and changed his apparel, and came into the house of the LORD, and worshipped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he did eat.* Then David arose from the earth and washed and anointed Himself and changed His clothes and went into the house of the LORD and worshiped. He then went to His own house. And when He asked, they set food before Him. He ate.
- 21 *Then said his servants unto him, What thing is this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, while it was alive; but when the child was dead, thou didst rise and eat bread.* Then His servants said to him, "What is this thing that You have done? You fasted and wept for the child while it was alive, but when the child died, you arose and ate food."
- 22 *And he said, While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept: for I said, Who can tell whether GOD will be gracious to me, that the child may live?* He said, "While the child was still alive, I fasted and wept, for I said, 'Who knows whether GOD will be gracious to me, that the child may live?'"
- 23 *But now he is dead, wherefore should I fast? can I bring him back again? I shall go to him, but he shall not return to me.* But now He is dead. Why should I fast? Can I bring Him back again? I shall go to Him. But He will not return to me."
- 24 *And David comforted Bathsheba his wife, and went in unto her, and lay with her: and she bare a son, and he called his name Solomon: and the LORD loved him.* Then David comforted his wife Bathsheba, and went in to her and lay with her. She bore a son. He called His name Solomon. And the LORD loved Him
- 25 *And he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet; and he called his name Jedidiah, because of the LORD.* Sent a message by Nathan the prophet. So he called his name Jedidiah, because of the LORD.
- 26 *And Joab fought against Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and took the royal city.* Now Joab fought against Rabbah of the Ammonites and captured the royal city.

- 27 *And Joab sent messengers to David, and said, I have fought against Rabbah, and have taken the city of waters.* Joab sent messengers to David and said, "I have fought against Rabbah; moreover, I have taken the city of waters.
- 28 *Now therefore gather the rest of the people together, and encamp against the city, and take it: lest I take the city, and it be called after my name.* Now therefore gather the rest of the people together and encamp against the city and take it, lest I take the city and it be called by my name."
- 29 *And David gathered all the people together, and went to Rabbah, and fought against it, and took it.* So David gathered all the people together and went to Rabbah and fought against it and took it.
- 30 *And he took their king's crown from off his head, the weight whereof was a talent of gold with the precious stones: and it was set on David's head. And he brought forth the spoil of the city in great abundance.* He took the crown of their king from his head. The weight of it was a talent of gold, and in it was a precious stone. It was placed on David's head. And he brought out the spoil of the city, a very great amount.
- 31 *And he brought forth the people that were therein, and put them under saws, and under harrows of iron, and under axes of iron, and made them pass through the brickkiln: and thus did he unto all the cities of the children of Ammon. So David and all the people returned unto Jerusalem.* He brought out the people who were in it and set them to labor with saws and iron picks and iron axes and made them toil at the brick kilns. And thus he did to all the cities of the Ammonites. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Bathsheba (*bath-SHEE-bah*) — The wife of Uriah whom David took in adultery — after Uriah's death she married David; mother of Solomon; her name means 'daughter of the oath.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Gen 38:24; 1 Sam 26:16; Rom 2:1
- v6 — Ex 22:1; Prov 6:31; Luke 19:8
- v7 — 1 Sam 16:13; Matt 14:14
- v8 — Ps 84:11; Rom 8:32; 2 Sam 9:7
- v9 — 1 Sam 15:19
- v11 — 2 Sam 16:21-22; Deut 28:30
- v12 — 2 Sam 16:22
- v13 — Prov 28:13; Ps 51:4; Zech 3:4; 2 Sam 24:10; Luke 15:21
- v14 — Rom 2:24; Isa 52:5; Ps 89:31-33
- v16 — 2 Sam 13:31
- v20 — Job 1:20; Ruth 3:3
- v22 — Isa 38:5; Isa 38:1-3

Chapter 13

David's son Amnon raped his half-sister Tamar, and David was furious but did nothing. Two years later, Absalom avenged Tamar by having his servants kill Amnon at a feast, then fled to Geshur.

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| <p>¹ <i>And it came to pass after this, that Absalom the son of David had a fair sister, whose name was Tamar; and Amnon the son of David loved her.</i></p> | <p>Now Absalom, David's son, had a beautiful sister whose name was Tamar. And Amnon the son of David loved her.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tamar** (*TAY-mar*) — "palm tree" — Absalom's beautiful sister (David's daughter). She was violated by her half-brother Amnon, who then cruelly rejected her. This crime triggered Absalom's vengeful murder of Amnon and ultimately his rebellion against David.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amnon** (*AM-non*) — "faithful" — David's firstborn son. He violated his half-sister Tamar and was murdered two years later by Absalom's servants at a sheep-shearing feast — the beginning of the sword that would not depart from David's house.

- 2 *And Amnon was so vexed, that he fell sick for his sister Tamar; for she was a virgin; and Amnon thought it hard for him to do any thing to her.* Amnon was so tormented that he made himself ill because of his sister Tamar, for she was a virgin. It seemed impossible to Amnon to do anything to her.
- 3 *But Amnon had a friend, whose name was Jonadab, the son of Shimeah David's brother: and Jonadab was a very subtil man.* But Amnon had a friend, whose name was Jonadab, the son of Shimeah, David's brother. And Jonadab was a very crafty man.
- 4 *And he said unto him, Why art thou, being the king's son, lean from day to day? wilt thou not tell me? And Amnon said unto him, I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister.* He said to him, "O son of the king, why are you so haggard morning after morning? Will you not tell me?" Amnon told him, "I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister."
- 5 *And Jonadab said unto him, Lay thee down on thy bed, and make thyself sick: and when thy father cometh to see thee, say unto him, I pray thee, let my sister Tamar come, and give me meat, and dress the meat in my sight, that I may see it, and eat it at her hand.* Jonadab said to him, "Lie down on your bed and pretend to be ill. And when your father comes to see you, say to him, 'Let my sister Tamar come and give me bread to eat, and prepare the food in my sight, that I may see it and eat it from her hand.' "
- 6 *So Amnon lay down, and made himself sick: and when the king was come to see him, Amnon said unto the king, I pray thee, let Tamar my sister come, and make me a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat at her hand.* So Amnon lay down and pretended to be ill. And when the king came to see him, Amnon said to the king, "Please let my sister Tamar come and make a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat from her hand."
- 7 *Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, Go now to thy brother Amnon's house, and dress him meat.* Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, "Go to your brother Amnon's house and prepare food for him."

- 8 *So Tamar went to her brother Amnon's house; and he was laid down. And she took flour, and kneaded it, and made cakes in his sight, and did bake the cakes.* So Tamar went to her brother Amnon's house, where he was lying down. And she took dough and kneaded it and made cakes in his sight and baked the cakes.
- 9 *And she took a pan, and poured them out before him; but he refused to eat. And Amnon said, Have out all men from me. And they went out every man from him.* She took the pan and poured them out before him. But he refused to eat. And Amnon said, "Send out everyone from me." So everyone went out from him.
- 10 *And Amnon said unto Tamar, Bring the meat into the chamber, that I may eat of thine hand. And Tamar took the cakes which she had made, and brought them into the chamber to Amnon her brother.* Then Amnon said to Tamar, "Bring the food into the chamber, that I may eat from your hand." And Tamar took the cakes she had made and brought them into the chamber to Amnon her brother.
- 11 *And when she had brought them unto him to eat, he took hold of her, and said unto her, Come lie with me, my sister.* But when she brought them near him to eat, he took hold of her and said to her, "Come, lie with me, my sister."
- 12 *And she answered him, Nay, my brother, do not force me; for no such thing ought to be done in Israel: do not thou this folly.* She answered him, "No, my brother, do not violate me, for such a thing is not done in Israel; do not do this outrageous thing.
- 13 *And I, whither shall I cause my shame to go? and as for thee, thou shalt be as one of the fools in Israel. Now therefore, I pray thee, speak unto the king; for he will not withhold me from thee.* As for me, where could I carry my shame? And as for you, you would be as one of the outrageous fools in Israel. Now therefore, please speak to the king, for he will not withhold me from you."
- 14 *Howbeit he would not hearken unto her voice: but, being stronger than she, forced her, and lay with her.* But he would not listen to her, and being stronger than she, he violated her and lay with her.

- 15 *Then Amnon hated her exceedingly; so that the hatred wherewith he hated her was greater than the love wherewith he had loved her. And Amnon said unto her, Arise, be gone.* Then Amnon hated her with very great hatred, so that the hatred with which he hated her was greater than the love with which he had loved her. And Amnon said to her, "Get up! Go!"
- 16 *And she said unto him, There is no cause: this evil in sending me away is greater than the other that thou didst unto me. But he would not hearken unto her.* But she said to him, "No, my brother, for this wrong in sending me away is greater than the other that you did to me." But he would not listen to her.
- 17 *Then he called his servant that ministered unto him, and said, Put now this woman out from me, and bolt the door after her.* He called the young man who served him and said, "Put this woman out of my presence and bolt the door after her."
- 18 *And she had a garment of divers colours upon her: for with such robes were the king's daughters that were virgins apparelled. Then his servant brought her out, and bolted the door after her.* Now she was wearing a long robe with sleeves, for thus were the virgin daughters of the king dressed. So his servant put her out and bolted the door after her.
- 19 *And Tamar put ashes on her head, and rent her garment of divers colours that was on her, and laid her hand on her head, and went on crying.* Tamar put ashes on her head and tore the long robe that she wore. And she laid her hand on her head and went away, crying aloud as she went.
- 20 *And Absalom her brother said unto her, Hath Amnon thy brother been with thee? but hold now thy peace, my sister: he is thy brother; regard not this thing. So Tamar remained desolate in her brother Absalom's house.* Her brother Absalom said to her, "Has Amnon your brother been with you? Now hold your peace, my sister. He is your brother; do not take this to heart." So Tamar lived, a desolate woman, in her brother Absalom's house.
- 21 *But when king David heard of all these things, he was very wroth.* When King David heard of all these things, he was very angry.

- 22 *And Absalom spake unto his brother Amnon neither good nor bad: for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.* But Absalom spoke to Amnon neither good nor bad, for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had violated his sister Tamar.
- 23 *And it came to pass after two full years, that Absalom had sheepshearers in Baalhazor, which is beside Ephraim: and Absalom invited all the king's sons.* After two full years Absalom had sheepshearers at Baal-hazor, which is near Ephraim, and Absalom invited all the king's sons.
- 24 *And Absalom came to the king, and said, Behold now, thy servant hath sheepshearers; let the king, I beseech thee, and his servants go with thy servant.* Absalom came to the king and said, "See, your servant has sheepshearers. Please let the king and his servants go with your servant."
- 25 *And the king said to Absalom, Nay, my son, let us not all now go, lest we be chargeable unto thee. And he pressed him: howbeit he would not go, but blessed him.* But the king said to Absalom, "No, my son, let us not all go, lest we be burdensome to you." He pressed him. But he would not go but gave him his blessing.
- 26 *Then said Absalom, If not, I pray thee, let my brother Amnon go with us. And the king said unto him, Why should he go with thee?* Then Absalom said, "If not, please let my brother Amnon go with us." And the king said to him, "Why should he go with you?"
- 27 *But Absalom pressed him, that he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him.* But Absalom pressed him until he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him.
- 28 *Now Absalom had commanded his servants, saying, Mark ye now when Amnon's heart is merry with wine, and when I say unto you, Smite Amnon; then kill him, fear not: have not I commanded you? be courageous, and be valiant.* Then Absalom commanded his servants, "Mark when Amnon's heart is merry with wine, and when I say to you, 'Strike Amnon,' then kill him. Do not fear; have I not commanded you? Be courageous and be valiant."

- 29 *And the servants of Absalom did unto Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and every man gat him up upon his mule, and fled.* So the servants of Absalom did to Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and each mounted his mule and fled.
- 30 *And it came to pass, while they were in the way, that tidings came to David, saying, Absalom hath slain all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left.* While they were on the way, news came to David, "Absalom has struck down all the king's sons, and not one of them is left."
- 31 *Then the king arose, and tare his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes rent.* Then the king arose and tore his garments and lay on the earth. And all his servants who were standing by tore their garments.
- 32 *And Jonadab, the son of Shimeah David's brother, answered and said, Let not my lord suppose that they have slain all the young men the king's sons; for Amnon only is dead: for by the appointment of Absalom this hath been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar.* But Jonadab the son of Shimeah, David's brother, said, "Let not my lord suppose that they have killed all the young men the king's sons, for Amnon alone is dead. For by the command of Absalom this has been determined from the day he violated his sister Tamar.
- 33 *Now therefore let not my lord the king take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king's sons are dead: for Amnon only is dead.* Now therefore let not my lord the king so take it to heart as to think that all the king's sons are dead, for Amnon alone is dead."
- 34 *But Absalom fled. And the young man that kept the watch lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, there came much people by the way of the hill side behind him.* But Absalom fled. And the young man who kept the watch lifted up his eyes and looked, and there came much people by the road behind him by the side of the mountain.
- 35 *And Jonadab said unto the king, Behold, the king's sons come: as thy servant said, so it is.* Jonadab said to the king, "See, the king's sons have come; as your servant said, so it is."

- 36 *And it came to pass, as soon as he had made an end of speaking, that, behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voice and wept: and the king also and all his servants wept very sore.* As soon as he had finished speaking, the king's sons came and lifted up their voice and wept. And the king also and all his servants wept very bitterly.
- 37 *But Absalom fled, and went to Talmai, the son of Ammihud, king of Geshur. And David mourned for his son every day.* But Absalom fled and went to Talmai the son of Ammihud, king of Geshur. And David mourned for his son day after day.
- 38 *So Absalom fled, and went to Geshur, and was there three years.* So Absalom fled and went to Geshur, and was there three years.
- 39 *And the soul of king David longed to go forth unto Absalom: for he was comforted concerning Amnon, seeing he was dead.* The soul of the king longed to go out to Absalom, because he was comforted about Amnon, since he was dead.

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 3:9; 2 Sam 3:2-3
v3 — 1 Sam 16:9
v6 — Gen 18:6
v9 — Gen 45:1
v12 — Judg 19:23; Judg 20:6; Lev 20:17
v22 — Gen 31:24; Lev 19:17-18
v28 — Judg 19:6
v31 — 2 Sam 1:11; 2 Sam 12:16
v37 — 2 Sam 3:3

Chapter 14

Joab sent a wise woman from Tekoa to persuade David to bring Absalom back from exile. David permitted Absalom's return to Jerusalem but refused to see him for two years, until Absalom forced a meeting by setting Joab's field on fire.

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| 1 | <i>Now Joab the son of Zeruiah perceived that the king's heart was toward Absalom.</i> | Now Joab the son of Zeruiah knew that the king's heart went out to Absalom. |
| 2 | <i>And Joab sent to Tekoah, and fetched thence a wise woman, and said unto her, I pray thee, feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on now mourning apparel, and anoint not thyself with oil, but be as a woman that had a long time mourned for the dead:</i> | Joab sent to Tekoa and brought from there a wise woman and said to her, "Please pretend to be a mourner, and put on mourning garments. Do not anoint yourself with oil, but behave like a woman who has been mourning many days for the dead. |
| 3 | <i>And come to the king, and speak on this manner unto him. So Joab put the words in her mouth.</i> | Go to the king and speak to him in this way." And Joab put the words in her mouth. |
| 4 | <i>And when the woman of Tekoah spake to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, and did obeisance, and said, Help, O king.</i> | When the woman of Tekoa came to the king, she fell on her face to the ground and paid homage and said, "Help, O king!" |
| 5 | <i>And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, I am indeed a widow woman, and mine husband is dead.</i> | The king said to her, "What is your trouble?" She answered, "Alas, I am a widow; my husband is dead. |
| 6 | <i>And thy handmaid had two sons, and they two strove together in the field, and there was none to part them, but the one smote the other, and slew him.</i> | Your servant had two sons. They quarreled with one another in the field. There was no one to separate them, and one struck the other and killed him. |

- 7 *And, behold, the whole family is risen against thine handmaid, and they said, Deliver him that smote his brother, that we may kill him, for the life of his brother whom he slew; and we will destroy the heir also: and so they shall quench my coal which is left, and shall not leave to my husband neither name nor remainder upon the earth.* Now the whole clan has risen against your servant. They say, 'Give up the man who struck his brother, that we may put him to death for the life of his brother whom he killed.' And so they would destroy the heir also. Thus they would quench my coal that is left and leave to my husband neither name nor remnant on the face of the earth."
- 8 *And the king said unto the woman, Go to thine house, and I will give charge concerning thee.* Then the king said to the woman, "Go to your house. I will give orders concerning you."
- 9 *And the woman of Tekoah said unto the king, My lord, O king, the iniquity be on me, and on my father's house: and the king and his throne be guiltless.* The woman of Tekoa said to the king, "On me be the guilt, my lord the king, and on my father's house; let the king and his throne be guiltless."
- 10 *And the king said, Whosoever saith ought unto thee, bring him to me, and he shall not touch thee any more.* The king said, "If anyone says anything to you, bring him to me. He shall never touch you again."
- 11 *Then said she, I pray thee, let the king remember the LORD thy God, that thou wouldest not suffer the revengers of blood to destroy any more, lest they destroy my son. And he said, As the LORD liveth, there shall not one hair of thy son fall to the earth.* Then she said, "Please let the king invoke the LORD Your God, that the avenger of blood kill no more, and my son not be destroyed." He said, "As the LORD lives, not one hair of Your son shall fall to the ground."
- 12 *Then the woman said, Let thine handmaid, I pray thee, speak one word unto my lord the king. And he said, Say on.* Then the woman said, "Please let your servant speak a word to my lord the king." He said, "Speak."

- 13 *And the woman said, Wherefore then hast thou thought such a thing against the people of God? for the king doth speak this thing as one which is faulty, in that the king doth not fetch home again his banished.* The woman said, "Why then have you planned such a thing against the people of God? For in giving this decision the king convicts himself, inasmuch as the king does not bring his banished one home again.
- 14 *For we must needs die, and are as water spilt on the ground, which cannot be gathered up again; neither doth God respect any person: yet doth he devise means, that his banished be not expelled from him.* We must all die; we are like water spilled on the ground, which cannot be gathered up again. Yet God does not respect any person. He devises means so that the banished one will not remain an outcast.
- 15 *Now therefore that I am come to speak of this thing unto my lord the king, it is because the people have made me afraid: and thy handmaid said, I will now speak unto the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his handmaid.* Now I have come to say this to my lord the king because the people have made me afraid, and your servant thought, 'I will speak to the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his servant.
- 16 *For the king will hear, to deliver his handmaid out of the hand of the man that would destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of God.* For the king will hear and deliver his servant from the hand of the man who would destroy me and my son together from the heritage of God.'
- 17 *Then thine handmaid said, The word of my lord the king shall now be comfortable: for as an angel of God, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad: therefore the LORD thy God will be with thee.* Your servant thought, 'The word of my lord the king will set me at rest,' for my lord the king is like the angel of God to discern good and evil. The LORD Your God be with You!"
- 18 *Then the king answered and said unto the woman, Hide not from me, I pray thee, the thing that I shall ask thee. And the woman said, Let my lord the king now speak.* Then the king answered the woman, "Do not hide from me anything I ask you." And the woman said, "Let my lord the king speak."

- 19 *And the king said, Is not the hand of Joab with thee in all this? And the woman answered and said, As thy soul liveth, my lord the king, none can turn to the right hand or to the left from ought that my lord the king hath spoken: for thy servant Joab, he bade me, and he put all these words in the mouth of thine handmaid:*
- The king said, "Is the hand of Joab with you in all this?" The woman answered and said, "As surely as you live, my lord the king, one cannot turn to the right hand or to the left from anything that my lord the king has said. It was your servant Joab who commanded me; it was he who put all these words in the mouth of your servant.
- 20 *To fetch about this form of speech hath thy servant Joab done this thing: and my lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth.*
- In order to change the course of things your servant Joab did this. But my lord has wisdom like the wisdom of the angel of God to know all things that are on earth."
- 21 *And the king said unto Joab, Behold now, I have done this thing: go therefore, bring the young man Absalom again.*
- Then the king said to Joab, "See now, I grant this; go, bring back the young man Absalom."
- 22 *And Joab fell to the ground on his face, and bowed himself, and thanked the king: and Joab said, To day thy servant knoweth that I have found grace in thy sight, my lord, O king, in that the king hath fulfilled the request of his servant.*
- Joab fell on his face to the ground and paid homage and blessed the king. And Joab said, "Today your servant knows that I have found favor in your sight, my lord the king, in that the king has granted the request of his servant."
- 23 *So Joab arose and went to Geshur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem.*
- So Joab arose and went to Geshur and brought Absalom to Jerusalem.
- 24 *And the king said, Let him turn to his own house, and let him not see my face. So Absalom returned to his own house, and saw not the king's face.*
- The king said, "Let him dwell apart in his own house; he is not to come into my presence." So Absalom lived apart in his own house and did not come into the king's presence.

- 25 *But in all Israel there was none to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty: from the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him.* Now in all Israel there was no one so much to be praised for his handsome appearance as Absalom. From the sole of his foot to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him.
- 26 *And when he polled his head, (for it was at every year's end that he polled it: because the hair was heavy on him, therefore he polled it:) he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels after the king's weight.* When he cut the hair of his head (for at the end of every year he used to cut it; when it was heavy on him, he cut it), he weighed the hair of his head, two hundred shekels by the king's weight.
- 27 *And unto Absalom there were born three sons, and one daughter, whose name was Tamar: she was a woman of a fair countenance.* There were born to Absalom three sons, and one daughter whose name was Tamar. She was a woman of a fair countenance.
- 28 *So Absalom dwelt two full years in Jerusalem, and saw not the king's face.* So Absalom lived two full years in Jerusalem, without coming into the king's presence.
- 29 *Therefore Absalom sent for Joab, to have sent him to the king; but he would not come to him: and when he sent again the second time, he would not come.* Then Absalom sent for Joab, to send him to the king, but Joab would not come to him. And he sent a second time, but Joab would not come.
- 30 *Therefore he said unto his servants, See, Joab's field is near mine, and he hath barley there; go and set it on fire. And Absalom's servants set the field on fire.* Then he said to his servants, "See, Joab's field is next to mine. He has barley there; go and set it on fire." So Absalom's servants set the field on fire.
- 31 *Then Joab arose, and came to Absalom unto his house, and said unto him, Wherefore have thy servants set my field on fire?* Then Joab arose and came to Absalom at his house and said to him, "Why have your servants set my field on fire?"

- 32 *And Absalom answered Joab, Behold, I sent unto thee, saying, Come hither, that I may send thee to the king, to say, Wherefore am I come from Geshur? it had been good for me to have been there still: now therefore let me see the king's face; and if there be any iniquity in me, let him kill me.* Absalom answered Joab, "I sent word to you, 'Come here, that I may send you to the king, to ask, "Why have I come from Geshur? It would be better for me to still be there.'" Now therefore let me see the king's face, and if there is guilt in me, let him put me to death."
- 33 *So Joab came to the king, and told him: and when he had called for Absalom, he came to the king, and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king: and the king kissed Absalom.* Then Joab went to the king and told him. And he summoned Absalom. So he came to the king and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king, and the king kissed Absalom.

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Sam 13:39
- v2 — 2 Chr 11:6
- v3 — 2 Sam 14:19
- v9 — 1 Sam 25:24
- v11 — 1 Sam 14:45
- v13 — 2 Sam 13:37-38
- v14 — Job 30:23; Heb 9:27; Num 35:28; Num 35:25; Num 35:15
- v17 — 1 Sam 29:9; 2 Sam 19:27
- v19 — 2 Sam 14:3
- v20 — 2 Sam 14:17; 2 Sam 19:27
- v25 — Isa 1:6; Job 2:7; Deut 28:35
- v33 — Luke 15:20; Gen 33:4

Chapter 15

Absalom spent four years winning the hearts of the people at the gate, then declared himself king at Hebron. David fled Jerusalem with his household and loyal servants; he sent Hushai back as a spy to counter the counsel of Ahithophel.

- 1 *And it came to pass after this, that Absalom prepared him chariots and horses, and fifty men to run before him.* After this Absalom got himself a chariot and horses, and fifty men to run before him.
- 2 *And Absalom rose up early, and stood beside the way of the gate: and it was so, that when any man that had a controversy came to the king for judgment, then Absalom called unto him, and said, Of what city art thou? And he said, Thy servant is of one of the tribes of Israel.* Absalom used to rise early and stand beside the way of the gate. And when any man had a dispute to come before the king for judgment, Absalom would call to him and say, "From what city are you?" And when he said, "Your servant is of such and such a tribe in Israel,"
- 3 *And Absalom said unto him, See, thy matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed of the king to hear thee.* Absalom would say to him, "See, your claims are good and right, but there is no man designated by the king to hear you."
- 4 *Absalom said moreover, Oh that I were made judge in the land, that every man which hath any suit or cause might come unto me, and I would do him justice!* Then Absalom would say, "Oh that I were judge in the land! Then every man with a dispute or cause might come to me. I would give him justice."
- 5 *And it was so, that when any man came nigh to him to do him obeisance, he put forth his hand, and took him, and kissed him.* Whenever a man came near to pay homage to him, he would put out his hand and take hold of him and kiss him.
- 6 *And on this manner did Absalom to all Israel that came to the king for judgment: so Absalom stole the hearts of the men of Israel.* Thus Absalom did to all of Israel who came to the king for judgment. So Absalom stole the hearts of the men of Israel.
- 7 *And it came to pass after forty years, that Absalom said unto the king, I pray thee, let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed unto the LORD, in Hebron.* At the end of forty years Absalom said to the king, "Please let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed to the LORD, in Hebron."

- 8 *For thy servant vowed a vow while I abode at Geshur in Syria, saying, If the LORD shall bring me again indeed to Jerusalem, then I will serve the LORD.* For Your servant vowed a vow while I lived at Geshur in Aram, saying, 'If the LORD will indeed bring me back to Jerusalem, then I will offer worship to the LORD.' "
- 9 *And the king said unto him, Go in peace. So he arose, and went to Hebron.* The king said to him, "Go in peace." So he arose and went to Hebron.
- 10 *But Absalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, As soon as ye hear the sound of the trumpet, then ye shall say, Absalom reigneth in Hebron.* But Absalom sent secret messengers throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "As soon as you hear the sound of the trumpet, then say, 'Absalom is king at Hebron!'"
- 11 *And with Absalom went two hundred men out of Jerusalem, that were called; and they went in their simplicity, and they knew not any thing.* With Absalom went two hundred men from Jerusalem who were invited guests. They went in their innocence and knew nothing.
- 12 *And Absalom sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city, even from Giloh, while he offered sacrifices. And the conspiracy was strong; for the people increased continually with Absalom.* While Absalom was offering the sacrifices, he sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counselor, from his city Giloh. And the conspiracy grew strong, and the people with Absalom kept increasing.
- 13 *And there came a messenger to David, saying, The hearts of the men of Israel are after Absalom.* A messenger came to David, saying, "The hearts of the men of Israel have gone after Absalom."
- 14 *And David said unto all his servants that were with him at Jerusalem, Arise, and let us flee; for we shall not else escape from Absalom: make speed to depart, lest he overtake us suddenly, and bring evil upon us, and smite the city with the edge of the sword.* Then David said to all his servants who were with him at Jerusalem, "Arise, and let us flee, or else there will be no escape for us from Absalom. Go quickly, lest he overtake us quickly and bring down ruin on us and strike the city with the edge of the sword."

- 15 *And the king's servants said unto the king, Behold, thy servants are ready to do whatsoever my lord the king shall appoint.* The king's servants said to the king, "See, your servants are ready to do whatever my lord the king decides."
- 16 *And the king went forth, and all his household after him. And the king left ten women, which were concubines, to keep the house.* So the king went out, and all his household after him. And the king left ten concubines to keep the house.
- 17 *And the king went forth, and all the people after him, and tarried in a place that was far off.* The king went out, and all the people after him. They halted at the last house.
- 18 *And all his servants passed on beside him; and all the Cherethites, and all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites, six hundred men which came after him from Gath, passed on before the king.* All his servants passed by him, all the Cherethites and all the Pelethites and all the six hundred Gittites who had followed him from Gath, and they passed on before the king.
- 19 *Then said the king to Ittai the Gittite, Wherefore goest thou also with us? return to thy place, and abide with the king: for thou art a stranger, and also an exile.* Then the king said to Ittai the Gittite, "Why do you also go with us? Go back and stay with the king, for you are a foreigner and also an exile from your home.
- 20 *Whereas thou camest but yesterday, should I this day make thee go up and down with us? seeing I go whither I may, return thou, and take back thy brethren: mercy and truth be with thee.* You came only yesterday, and shall I today make You wander about with us, since I go I know not where? Go back and take Your brothers with You, and may the LORD show mercy and truth to You."
- 21 *And Ittai answered the king, and said, As the LORD liveth, and as my lord the king liveth, surely in what place my lord the king shall be, whether in death or life, even there also will thy servant be.* But Ittai answered the king, "As the LORD lives, and as my lord the king lives, wherever my lord the king shall be, whether in death or life, even there also will Your servant be."

- 22 *And David said to Ittai, Go and pass over. And Ittai the Gittite passed over, and all his men, and all the little ones that were with him.* David said to Ittai, "Go then, pass on." So Ittai the Gittite passed on, with all his men and all the little ones who were with him.
- 23 *And all the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over, toward the way of the wilderness.* All the land wept aloud as all the people passed by, and the king crossed the brook Kidron. All the people passed on toward the wilderness.
- 24 *And lo Zadok also, and all the Levites were with him, bearing the ark of the covenant of God: and they set down the ark of God; and Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city.* Zadok came also. All the Levites with him, carrying the ark of the covenant of God. And they set down the ark of God until the people had all passed out of the city.
- 25 *And the king said unto Zadok, Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find favour in the eyes of the LORD, he will bring me again, and shew me both it, and his habitation:* Then the king said to Zadok, "Carry the ark of God back into the city. If I find favor in the eyes of the LORD, He will bring me back and let me see both it and His dwelling place.
- 26 *But if he thus say, I have no delight in thee; behold, here am I, let him do to me as seemeth good unto him.* But if He says, 'I have no pleasure in You,' here I am, let Him do to me what seems good to Him."
- 27 *The king said also unto Zadok the priest, Art not thou a seer? return into the city in peace, and your two sons with you, Ahimaaz thy son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar.* The king also said to Zadok the priest, "Are you not a seer? Go back to the city in peace, with your two sons, Ahimaaz your son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar.
- 28 *See, I will tarry in the plain of the wilderness, until there come word from you to certify me.* See, I will wait at the fords of the wilderness until word comes from you to inform me."
- 29 *Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried the ark of God again to Jerusalem: and they tarried there.* So Zadok and Abiathar carried the ark of God back to Jerusalem. They remained there.

- 30 *And David went up by the ascent of mount Olivet, and wept as he went up, and had his head covered, and he went barefoot: and all the people that was with him covered every man his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up.* But David went up the ascent of the Mount of Olives, weeping as he went, barefoot and with his head covered. And all the people who were with him covered their heads. They went up, weeping as they went.
- 31 *And one told David, saying, Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom. And David said, O LORD, I pray thee, turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness.* It was told David, "Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom." And David said, "O LORD, please turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness."
- 32 *And it came to pass, that when David was come to the top of the mount, where he worshipped God, behold, Hushai the Archite came to meet him with his coat rent, and earth upon his head:* When David came to the summit, where God was worshiped, there came Hushai the Archite to meet him with his coat torn and dirt on His head.
- 33 *Unto whom David said, If thou passest on with me, then thou shalt be a burden unto me:* David said to him, "If you go on with me, you will be a burden to me."
- 34 *But if thou return to the city, and say unto Absalom, I will be thy servant, O king; as I have been thy father's servant hitherto, so will I now also be thy servant: then mayest thou for me defeat the counsel of Ahithophel.* But if you return to the city and say to Absalom, 'I will be your servant, O king; as I have been your father's servant in time past, so now I will be your servant,' then you will defeat for me the counsel of Ahithophel.
- 35 *And hast thou not there with thee Zadok and Abiathar the priests? therefore it shall be, that what thing soever thou shalt hear out of the king's house, thou shalt tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests.* Are not Zadok and Abiathar the priests there with you? So whatever you hear from the king's house, tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests.

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| <p>36 <i>Behold, they have there with them their two sons, Ahimaaz Zadok's son, and Jonathan Abiathar's son; and by them ye shall send unto me every thing that ye can hear.</i></p> <p>37 <i>So Hushai David's friend came into the city, and Absalom came into Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Their two sons are there with them, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and Jonathan, Abiathar's son, and by them you shall send to me everything you hear."</p> <p>So Hushai, David's friend, came into the city, just as Absalom was entering Jerusalem.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 1:5
 v4 — Judg 9:29
 v6 — Rom 16:18
 v12 — 2 Sam 15:31; Ps 41:9; Josh 15:51
 v16 — 2 Sam 16:21-22
 v20 — 1 Sam 23:13; 2 Sam 2:6
 v21 — Ruth 1:16-17; Prov 17:17
 v24 — 2 Sam 8:17; Num 4:15
 v26 — 1 Sam 3:18
 v27 — 2 Sam 17:17; 1 Sam 9:9
 v31 — 2 Sam 17:14; 2 Sam 17:23; Ps 41:9; Jas 3:15; Job 5:12
 v37 — 1 Chr 27:33; 2 Sam 16:15-16

Chapter 16

Ziba brought provisions to David and claimed Mephibosheth had stayed behind hoping to reclaim Saul's throne. Shimei cursed David and threw stones at him as he fled, and David restrained his men from killing Shimei.

- 1 *And when David was a little past the top of the hill, behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him, with a couple of asses saddled, and upon them two hundred loaves of bread, and an hundred bunches of raisins, and an hundred of summer fruits, and a bottle of wine.* When David had passed a little beyond the summit, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him, with a couple of donkeys saddled, bearing two hundred loaves of bread, a hundred bunches of raisins, a hundred of summer fruits, and a skin of wine.
- 2 *And the king said unto Ziba, What meanest thou by these? And Ziba said, The asses be for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that such as be faint in the wilderness may drink.* The king said to Ziba, "Why have you brought these?" Ziba answered, "The donkeys are for the king's household to ride on, the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat, and the wine for those who faint in the wilderness to drink."
- 3 *And the king said, And where is thy master's son? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he abideth at Jerusalem: for he said, To day shall the house of Israel restore me the kingdom of my father.* The king said, "And where is your master's son?" Ziba said to the king, "See, he remains in Jerusalem, for he said, 'Today the house of Israel will give me back the kingdom of my father.'"
- 4 *Then said the king to Ziba, Behold, thine are all that pertained unto Mephibosheth. And Ziba said, I humbly beseech thee that I may find grace in thy sight, my lord, O king.* Then the king said to Ziba, "See, all that belonged to Mephibosheth is now yours." And Ziba said, "I pay homage; let me ever find favor in your sight, my lord the king."
- 5 *And when king David came to Bahurim, behold, thence came out a man of the family of the house of Saul, whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera: he came forth, and cursed still as he came.* When King David came to Bahurim, there came out a man of the family of the house of Saul, whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera, and as he came he cursed continually.

- 6 *And he cast stones at David, and at all the servants of king David: and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left.* He threw stones at David and at all the servants of King David. All the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left.
- 7 *And thus said Shimei when he cursed, Come out, come out, thou bloody man, and thou man of Belial:* Shimei said as he cursed, "Get out, get out, you man of blood, you worthless man!"
- 8 *The LORD hath returned upon thee all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose stead thou hast reigned; and the LORD hath delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom thy son: and, behold, thou art taken in thy mischief, because thou art a bloody man.* The LORD has avenged on You all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose place you have reigned. The LORD has given the kingdom into the hand of Your son Absalom. See, your evil is on you, for you are a man of blood."
- 9 *Then said Abishai the son of Zeruiah unto the king, Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? let me go over, I pray thee, and take off his head.* Then Abishai the son of Zeruiah said to the king, "Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? Let me go over and take off his head."
- 10 *And the king said, What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah? so let him curse, because the LORD hath said unto him, Curse David. Who shall then say, Wherefore hast thou done so?* But the king said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah? If He is cursing because the LORD has said to Him, 'Curse David,' who then shall say, 'Why have you done so?'"
- 11 *And David said to Abishai, and to all his servants, Behold, my son, which came forth of my bowels, seeketh my life: how much more now may this Benjamite do it? let him alone, and let him curse; for the LORD hath bidden him.* David said to Abishai and to all his servants, "See, my own son seeks my life; how much more now may this Benjaminite! Leave Him alone, and let Him curse, for the LORD has told Him to.

- 12 *It may be that the LORD will look on mine affliction, and that the LORD will requite me good for his cursing this day.* It may be that the LORD will look on my affliction and that the LORD will repay me with good for His cursing today."
- 13 *And as David and his men went by the way, Shimei went along on the hill's side over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones at him, and cast dust.* So David and his men went on the road, while Shimei went along on the hillside opposite him and cursed as he went and threw stones at him and flung dust.
- 14 *And the king, and all the people that were with him, came weary, and refreshed themselves there.* The king. All the people who were with him, arrived weary at the Jordan. And there he refreshed himself.
- 15 *And Absalom, and all the people the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him.* Now Absalom and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him.
- 16 *And it came to pass, when Hushai the Archite, David's friend, was come unto Absalom, that Hushai said unto Absalom, God save the king, God save the king.* When Hushai the Archite, David's friend, came to Absalom, Hushai said to Absalom, "Long live the king! Long live the king!"
- 17 *And Absalom said to Hushai, Is this thy kindness to thy friend? why wentest thou not with thy friend?* Absalom said to Hushai, "Is this your loyalty to your friend? Why did you not go with your friend?"
- 18 *And Hushai said unto Absalom, Nay; but whom the LORD, and this people, and all the men of Israel, choose, his will I be, and with him will I abide.* Hushai said to Absalom, "No, for whom the LORD and this people and all the men of Israel have chosen, His I will be, and with Him I will remain.
- 19 *And again, whom should I serve? should I not serve in the presence of his son? as I have served in thy father's presence, so will I be in thy presence.* Again, whom should I serve? Should it not be His son? As I have served Your father, so I will serve You."

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| <p>20 <i>Then said Absalom to Ahithophel, Give counsel among you what we shall do.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Go in unto thy father's concubines, which he hath left to keep the house; and all Israel shall hear that thou art abhorred of thy father: then shall the hands of all that are with thee be strong.</i></p> <p>22 <i>So they spread Absalom a tent upon the top of the house; and Absalom went in unto his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And the counsel of Ahithophel, which he counselled in those days, was as if a man had enquired at the oracle of God: so was all the counsel of Ahithophel both with David and with Absalom.</i></p> | <p>Then Absalom said to Ahithophel, "Give your counsel. What shall we do?"</p> <p>Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Go in to your father's concubines, whom he has left to keep the house. All Israel will hear that you have made yourself a stench to your father, and the hands of all who are with you will be strengthened."</p> <p>So they pitched a tent for Absalom on the roof. And Absalom went in to his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel.</p> <p>Now in those days the counsel that Ahithophel gave was as if one consulted the word of God; so was all the counsel of Ahithophel esteemed, both by David and by Absalom.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Sam 25:18

v2 — 2 Sam 17:29

v4 — Prov 18:13; Prov 18:17

v5 — 2 Sam 3:16

v8 — 2 Sam 1:16

v9 — Ex 22:28; 2 Sam 9:8

v10 — 2 Sam 19:22; Rom 9:20

v12 — Deut 23:5; Heb 12:10; Matt 5:11-12; Ps 25:18; Rom 8:28

v15 — 2 Sam 15:37

v17 — 2 Sam 19:25

v19 — 2 Sam 15:34

v22 — 2 Sam 12:11-12; 2 Sam 15:16

Chapter 17

Ahithophel advised Absalom to pursue David immediately, but Hushai's counsel to delay prevailed, buying David time. When Ahithophel saw his counsel was rejected, he hanged himself; David crossed the Jordan and received supplies at Mahanaim.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Let me now choose out twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David this night:</i></p> | <p>Moreover, Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Let me choose twelve thousand men. I will arise and pursue David tonight.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And I will come upon him while he is weary and weak handed, and will make him afraid: and all the people that are with him shall flee; and I will smite the king only:</i></p> | <p>I will come upon him while he is weary and discouraged and throw him into a panic. All the people who are with him will flee. I will strike down only the king,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And I will bring back all the people unto thee: the man whom thou seekest is as if all returned: so all the people shall be in peace.</i></p> | <p>I will bring all the people back to you. The man whom you seek — when all return, all the people will be at peace."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the saying pleased Absalom well, and all the elders of Israel.</i></p> | <p>The advice pleased Absalom and all the elders of Israel.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Then said Absalom, Call now Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear likewise what he saith.</i></p> | <p>Then Absalom said, "Call Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear what he has to say."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And when Hushai was come to Absalom, Absalom spake unto him, saying, Ahithophel hath spoken after this manner: shall we do after his saying? if not; speak thou.</i></p> | <p>When Hushai came to Absalom, Absalom said to him, "Thus has Ahithophel spoken. Shall we do as he says? If not, you speak."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And Hushai said unto Absalom, The counsel that Ahithophel hath given is not good at this time.</i></p> | <p>Then Hushai said to Absalom, "This time the counsel that Ahithophel has given is not good."</p> |

- 8 *For, said Hushai, thou knowest thy father and his men, that they be mighty men, and they be chafed in their minds, as a bear robbed of her whelps in the field: and thy father is a man of war, and will not lodge with the people.* Hushai said, "You know that your father and his men are mighty men, and that they are enraged, like a bear robbed of her cubs in the field. Besides, your father is expert in war; he will not spend the night with the troops.
- 9 *Behold, he is hid now in some pit, or in some other place: and it will come to pass, when some of them be overthrown at the first, that whosoever heareth it will say, There is a slaughter among the people that follow Absalom.* Even now he has hidden himself in one of the pits or in some other place. And as soon as some of the people fall at the first attack, whoever hears it will say, 'There has been a slaughter among the people who follow Absalom.'
- 10 *And he also that is valiant, whose heart is as the heart of a lion, shall utterly melt: for all Israel knoweth that thy father is a mighty man, and they which be with him are valiant men.* Then even the valiant man, whose heart is like the heart of a lion, will utterly melt with fear, for all Israel knows that your father is a mighty man, and that those who are with him are valiant men.
- 11 *Therefore I counsel that all Israel be generally gathered unto thee, from Dan even to Beersheba, as the sand that is by the sea for multitude; and that thou go to battle in thine own person.* But my counsel is that all Israel be gathered to you, from Dan to Beersheba, as the sand by the sea for multitude, and that you go to battle in person.
- 12 *So shall we come upon him in some place where he shall be found, and we will light upon him as the dew falleth on the ground: and of him and of all the men that are with him there shall not be left so much as one.* So we shall come upon him in some place where he is to be found. We shall light on him as the dew falls on the ground, and of him and all the men with him not one will be left.

- 13 *Moreover, if he be gotten into a city, then shall all Israel bring ropes to that city, and we will draw it into the river, until there be not one small stone found there.* If he withdraws into a city, then all Israel will bring ropes to that city. We shall drag it into the valley, until not even a pebble is to be found there."
- 14 *And Absalom and all the men of Israel said, The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better than the counsel of Ahithophel. For the LORD had appointed to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent that the LORD might bring evil upon Absalom.* Absalom and all the men of Israel said, "The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better than the counsel of Ahithophel." For the LORD had ordained to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, so that the LORD might bring harm upon Absalom.
- 15 *Then said Hushai unto Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, Thus and thus did Ahithophel counsel Absalom and the elders of Israel; and thus and thus have I counselled.* Then Hushai said to Zadok and Abiathar the priests, "Thus and so did Ahithophel counsel Absalom and the elders of Israel, and thus and so have I counseled.
- 16 *Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying, Lodge not this night in the plains of the wilderness, but speedily pass over; lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people that are with him.* Now therefore send quickly and tell David, 'Do not stay tonight at the fords of the wilderness, but by all means cross over, lest the king and all the people who are with him be swallowed up.' "
- 17 *Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz stayed by Enrogel; for they might not be seen to come into the city: and a wench went and told them; and they went and told king David.* Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz were waiting at En-rogel. A female servant was to go and tell them. They were to go and tell King David, for they were not to be seen entering the city.
- 18 *Nevertheless a lad saw them, and told Absalom: but they went both of them away quickly, and came to a man's house in Bahurim, which had a well in his court; whither they went down.* But a young man saw them and told Absalom. So both of them went away quickly and came to the house of a man at Bahurim, who had a well in his courtyard. They went down into it.

- 19 *And the woman took and spread a covering over the well's mouth, and spread ground corn thereon; and the thing was not known.* The woman took and spread a covering over the well's mouth and scattered grain on it, and nothing was known of it.
- 20 *And when Absalom's servants came to the woman to the house, they said, Where is Ahimaaz and Jonathan? And the woman said unto them, They be gone over the brook of water. And when they had sought and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.* When Absalom's servants came to the woman at the house, they said, "Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan?" And the woman said to them, "They have gone over the brook of water." And when they had searched and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.
- 21 *And it came to pass, after they were departed, that they came up out of the well, and went and told king David, and said unto David, Arise, and pass quickly over the water: for thus hath Ahithophel counselled against you.* After they had gone, the men came up out of the well, and went and told King David. They said to David, "Arise, and go quickly over the water, for thus has Ahithophel counseled against you."
- 22 *Then David arose, and all the people that were with him, and they passed over Jordan: by the morning light there lacked not one of them that was not gone over Jordan.* Then David arose, and all the people who were with him, and they crossed the Jordan. By daybreak not one was left who had not crossed the Jordan.
- 23 *And when Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his ass, and arose, and gat him home to his house, to his city, and put his household in order, and hanged himself, and died, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father.* When Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his donkey and went off home to his own city. He set his house in order and hanged himself. He died and was buried in the tomb of his father.
- 24 *Then David came to Mahanaim. And Absalom passed over Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him.* Then David came to Mahanaim. And Absalom crossed the Jordan with all the men of Israel.

- 25 *And Absalom made Amasa captain of the host instead of Joab: which Amasa was a man's son, whose name was Ithra an Israelite, that went in to Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruiah Joab's mother.* Now Absalom had set Amasa over the army instead of Joab. Amasa was the son of a man named Ithra the Israelite, who had married Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister of Zeruiah, Joab's mother.
- 26 *So Israel and Absalom pitched in the land of Gilead.* Israel and Absalom encamped in the land of Gilead.
- 27 *And it came to pass, when David was come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim,* When David came to Mahanaim, Shobi the son of Nahash from Rabbah of the Ammonites, and Machir the son of Ammiel from Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite from Rogelim,
- 28 *Brought beds, and basons, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and flour, and parched corn, and beans, and lentiles, and parched pulse,* Brought beds, basins, and earthen vessels, wheat, barley, flour, parched grain, beans and lentils,
- 29 *And honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese of kine, for David, and for the people that were with him, to eat: for they said, The people is hungry, and weary, and thirsty, in the wilderness.* Honey and curds and sheep and cheese from the herd, for David and the people with him to eat, for they said, "The people are hungry and weary and thirsty in the wilderness."

Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 59:7-8

v2 — 2 Sam 16:14; 1 Kgs 22:31

v8 — Hos 13:8

v11 — Gen 22:17

v14 — 2 Sam 15:34; 1 Cor 1:19-20; Isa 8:10; Prov 19:21

- v16** — 2 Sam 15:28
v17 — 2 Sam 15:36; 2 Sam 15:27; Josh 18:16; Josh 15:7
v18 — 2 Sam 3:16
v23 — Matt 27:5; 2 Kgs 20:1; 2 Sam 15:12
v25 — 1 Chr 2:13; 2 Sam 19:13
v27 — 1 Kgs 2:7; 2 Sam 10:1-2; 2 Sam 9:4
v29 — 2 Sam 16:2

Chapter 18

David's army defeated Absalom's forces in the battle of the forest of Ephraim, where 20,000 men fell. Absalom's head was caught in an oak tree, and Joab killed him despite David's order to deal gently with him; David wept for his son.

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| <p>1 <i>And David numbered the people that were with him, and set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them.</i></p> | Then David mustered the men who were with him and set over them commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds. |
| <p>2 <i>And David sent forth a third part of the people under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. And the king said unto the people, I will surely go forth with you myself also.</i></p> | David sent out the army, one third under the command of Joab, one third under the command of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and one third under the command of Ittai the Gittite. And the king said to the men, "I myself will also go out with you." |
| <p>3 <i>But the people answered, Thou shalt not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not care for us; neither if half of us die, will they care for us: but now thou art worth ten thousand of us: therefore now it is better that thou succour us out of the city.</i></p> | But the men said, "You shall not go out. For if we flee, they will not care about us. If half of us die, they will not care about us. But you are worth ten thousand of us. Therefore it is better that you support us from the city." |
| <p>4 <i>And the king said unto them, What seemeth you best I will do. And the king stood by the gate side, and all the people came out by hundreds and by thousands.</i></p> | The king said to them, "Whatever seems best to you I will do." So the king stood at the side of the gate, while all the army marched out by hundreds and by thousands. |

- 5 *And the king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Deal gently for my sake with the young man, even with Absalom. And all the people heard when the king gave all the captains charge concerning Absalom.* The king ordered Joab and Abishai and Ittai, "Deal gently for my sake with the young man Absalom." And all the people heard when the king gave orders to all the commanders about Absalom.
- 6 *So the people went out into the field against Israel: and the battle was in the wood of Ephraim;* So the army went out into the field against Israel, and the battle was fought in the forest of Ephraim.
- 7 *Where the people of Israel were slain before the servants of David, and there was there a great slaughter that day of twenty thousand men.* The men of Israel were defeated there by the servants of David, and the slaughter there was great on that day, twenty thousand men.
- 8 *For the battle was there scattered over the face of all the country: and the wood devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.* The battle spread over the face of all the country, and the forest devoured more people that day than the sword.
- 9 *And Absalom met the servants of David. And Absalom rode upon a mule, and the mule went under the thick boughs of a great oak, and his head caught hold of the oak, and he was taken up between the heaven and the earth; and the mule that was under him went away.* Absalom happened to meet the servants of David. Absalom was riding on his mule, and the mule went under the thick branches of a great oak. His head caught fast in the oak. He was suspended between heaven and earth, while the mule that was under him went on.
- 10 *And a certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, Behold, I saw Absalom hanged in an oak.* A certain man saw it and told Joab, "I just saw Absalom hanging in an oak."
- 11 *And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest him, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten shekels of silver, and a girdle.* Joab said to the man who told him, "What, you saw him! Why then did you not strike him there to the ground? I would have been glad to give you ten pieces of silver and a belt."

- 12 *And the man said unto Joab, Though I should receive a thousand shekels of silver in mine hand, yet would I not put forth mine hand against the king's son: for in our hearing the king charged thee and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Beware that none touch the young man Absalom.* But the man said to Joab, "Even if I felt in my hand the weight of a thousand pieces of silver, I would not reach out my hand against the king's son, for in our hearing the king commanded you and Abishai and Ittai, 'For my sake protect the young man Absalom.'
- 13 *Otherwise I should have wrought falsehood against mine own life: for there is no matter hid from the king, and thou thyself wouldest have set thyself against me.* On the other hand, if I had dealt treacherously against his life (and there is nothing hidden from the king), then you yourself would have set yourself against me."
- 14 *Then said Joab, I may not tarry thus with thee. And he took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak.* Joab said, "I will not waste time like this with you." And he took three javelins in his hand and thrust them into the heart of Absalom while he was still alive in the oak.
- 15 *And ten young men that bare Joab's armour compassed about and smote Absalom, and slew him.* Ten young men, Joab's armor-bearers, surrounded Absalom and struck him and killed him.
- 16 *And Joab blew the trumpet, and the people returned from pursuing after Israel: for Joab held back the people.* Then Joab blew the trumpet, and the troops came back from pursuing Israel, for Joab restrained the troops.
- 17 *And they took Absalom, and cast him into a great pit in the wood, and laid a very great heap of stones upon him: and all Israel fled every one to his tent.* They took Absalom and threw him into a great pit in the forest and raised over him a very great heap of stones. And all Israel fled every one to his own home.

- 18 *Now Absalom in his lifetime had taken and reared up for himself a pillar, which is in the king's dale: for he said, I have no son to keep my name in remembrance: and he called the pillar after his own name: and it is called unto this day, Absalom's place.* Now Absalom in his lifetime had taken and set up for himself the pillar that is in the King's Valley, for he said, "I have no son to keep my name in remembrance." He called the pillar after his own name. It is called Absalom's monument to this day.
- 19 *Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok, Let me now run, and bear the king tidings, how that the LORD hath avenged him of his enemies.* Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said, "Let me run and carry news to the king that the LORD has delivered Him from the hand of His enemies."
- 20 *And Joab said unto him, Thou shalt not bear tidings this day, but thou shalt bear tidings another day: but this day thou shalt bear no tidings, because the king's son is dead.* Joab said to him, "You are not to carry news today. You may carry news another day, but today you shall carry no news, because the king's son is dead."
- 21 *Then said Joab to Cushi, Go tell the king what thou hast seen. And Cushi bowed himself unto Joab, and ran.* Then Joab said to the Cushite, "Go, tell the king what you have seen." The Cushite bowed before Joab and ran.
- 22 *Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok yet again to Joab, But howsoever, let me, I pray thee, also run after Cushi. And Joab said, Wherefore wilt thou run, my son, seeing that thou hast no tidings ready?* Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said again to Joab, "Come what may, please let me also run after the Cushite." And Joab said, "Why will you run, my son, seeing that you have no news ready?"
- 23 *But howsoever, said he, let me run. And he said unto him, Run. Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the plain, and overran Cushi.* "Come what may," he said, "I will run." So he said to him, "Run." Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the plain, and outran the Cushite.
- 24 *And David sat between the two gates: and the watchman went up to the roof over the gate unto the wall, and lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold a man running alone.* Now David was sitting between the two gates, and the watchman went up to the roof of the gate by the wall and lifted up his eyes and looked, and there was a man running alone.

- 25 *And the watchman cried, and told the king. And the king said, If he be alone, there is tidings in his mouth. And he came apace, and drew near.* The watchman called out and told the king. And the king said, "If he is alone, there is news in his mouth." And he drew nearer and nearer.
- 26 *And the watchman saw another man running, and the watchman called unto the porter, and said, Behold another man running alone. And the king said, He also bringeth tidings.* The watchman saw another man running. And the watchman called to the gate and said, "See, another man running alone!" The king said, "He also brings news."
- 27 *And the watchman said, Me thinketh the running of the foremost is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok. And the king said, He is a good man, and cometh with good tidings.* The watchman said, "I think the running of the first is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok." And the king said, "He is a good man and comes with good news."
- 28 *And Ahimaaz called, and said unto the king, All is well. And he fell down to the earth upon his face before the king, and said, Blessed be the LORD thy God, which hath delivered up the men that lifted up their hand against my lord the king.* Then Ahimaaz called out to the king, "All is well." And he bowed before the king with his face to the earth and said, "Blessed be the LORD your God, Who has delivered up the men who raised their hand against my lord the king."
- 29 *And the king said, Is the young man Absalom safe? And Ahimaaz answered, When Joab sent the king's servant, and me thy servant, I saw a great tumult, but I knew not what it was.* The king said, "Is it well with the young man Absalom?" Ahimaaz answered, "When Joab sent the king's servant and your servant, I saw a great commotion. But I do not know what it was."
- 30 *And the king said unto him, Turn aside, and stand here. And he turned aside, and stood still.* The king said, "Turn aside and stand here." So he turned aside and stood still.
- 31 *And, behold, Cushite came; and Cushite said, Tidings, my lord the king: for the LORD hath avenged thee this day of all them that rose up against thee.* The Cushite came, and the Cushite said, "Good news for my lord the king! For the LORD has delivered You this day from the hand of all who rose up against You."

- 32 *And the king said unto Cushi, Is the young man Absalom safe? And Cushi answered, The enemies of my lord the king, and all that rise against thee to do thee hurt, be as that young man is.* The king said to the Cushite, "Is it well with the young man Absalom?" And the Cushite answered, "May the enemies of my lord the king and all who rise up against you for evil be like that young man."
- 33 *And the king was much moved, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept: and as he went, thus he said, O my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom! would God I had died for thee, O Absalom, my son, my son!* The king was deeply moved and went up to the chamber over the gate and wept. And as he went, he said, "O my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom! Would I had died instead of you, O Absalom, my son, my son!"

Words in this chapter:

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Sam 21:17
- v6 — Josh 17:18
- v9 — 2 Sam 14:26
- v17 — Josh 8:29; Josh 7:26
- v19 — 2 Sam 15:36
- v27 — 2 Kgs 9:20
- v32 — Judg 5:31
- v33 — 2 Sam 19:4

Chapter 19

Joab rebuked David for mourning Absalom while his loyal men were shamed, and David returned to Jerusalem. The tribes disputed who should escort the king back; David forgave Shimei, resolved the dispute with Mephibosheth, and rewarded Barzillai.

- 1 *And it was told Joab, Behold, the king weepeth and mourneth for Absalom.* It was told Joab, "See, the king is weeping and mourning for Absalom."

- 2 *And the victory that day was turned into mourning unto all the people: for the people heard say that day how the king was grieved for his son.* So the victory that day was turned into mourning for all the people, for the people heard that day, "The king is grieving for his son."
- 3 *And the people gat them by stealth that day into the city, as people being ashamed steal away when they flee in battle.* The people stole into the city that day as people who are ashamed steal in when they flee in battle.
- 4 *But the king covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, O my son Absalom, O Absalom, my son, my son!* The king covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, "O my son Absalom, O Absalom, my son, my son!"
- 5 *And Joab came into the house to the king, and said, Thou hast shamed this day the faces of all thy servants, which this day have saved thy life, and the lives of thy sons and of thy daughters, and the lives of thy wives, and the lives of thy concubines;* Then Joab came into the house to the king and said, "You have today covered with shame the faces of all your servants, who have this day saved your life and the lives of your sons and your daughters and the lives of your wives and your concubines,
- 6 *In that thou lovest thine enemies, and hatest thy friends. For thou hast declared this day, that thou regardest neither princes nor servants: for this day I perceive, that if Absalom had lived, and all we had died this day, then it had pleased thee well.* Because you love those who hate you and hate those who love you. For you have made it clear today that commanders and servants are nothing to you, for today I know that if Absalom were alive and all of us were dead today, then you would be pleased.
- 7 *Now therefore arise, go forth, and speak comfortably unto thy servants: for I swear by the LORD, if thou go not forth, there will not tarry one with thee this night: and that will be worse unto thee than all the evil that befell thee from thy youth until now.* Now therefore arise, go out and speak kindly to Your servants, for I swear by the LORD, if You do not go, not a man will stay with you this night, and this will be worse for You than all the evil that has come upon You from Your youth until now."

- 8 *Then the king arose, and sat in the gate. And they told unto all the people, saying, Behold, the king doth sit in the gate. And all the people came before the king: for Israel had fled every man to his tent.* Then the king arose and sat in the gate. And the people were all told, "See, the king is sitting in the gate." And all the people came before the king. Now Israel had fled every man to his own home.
- 9 *And all the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, The king saved us out of the hand of our enemies, and he delivered us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now he is fled out of the land for Absalom.* All the people were arguing throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "The king delivered us from the hand of our enemies and saved us from the hand of the Philistines, and now he has fled out of the land from Absalom.
- 10 *And Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why speak ye not a word of bringing the king back?* But Absalom, whom we anointed over us, has died in battle. Now therefore why do you say nothing about bringing the king back?"
- 11 *And king David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, Speak unto the elders of Judah, saying, Why are ye the last to bring the king back to his house? seeing the speech of all Israel is come to the king, even to his house.* King David sent this message to Zadok and Abiathar the priests: "Say to the elders of Judah, 'Why should you be the last to bring the king back to his house, when the word of all Israel has come to the king?'
- 12 *Ye are my brethren, ye are my bones and my flesh: wherefore then are ye the last to bring back the king?* You are my brothers; you are my bone and my flesh. Why then should you be the last to bring back the king?"
- 13 *And say ye to Amasa, Art thou not of my bone, and of my flesh? God do so to me, and more also, if thou be not captain of the host before me continually in the room of Joab.* Say to Amasa, 'Are you not my bone and my flesh? God do so to me and more also, if you are not commander of my army from now on in place of Joab.' "

- 14 *And he bowed the heart of all the men of Judah, even as the heart of one man; so that they sent this word unto the king, Return thou, and all thy servants.* He swayed the heart of all the men of Judah as one man, so that they sent word to the king, "Return, both you and all your servants."
- 15 *So the king returned, and came to Jordan. And Judah came to Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to conduct the king over Jordan.* So the king came back to the Jordan, and Judah came to Gilgal to meet the king and to bring the king over the Jordan.
- 16 *And Shimei the son of Gera, a Benjamite, which was of Bahurim, hasted and came down with the men of Judah to meet king David.* Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjaminite, from Bahurim, hurried to come down with the men of Judah to meet King David.
- 17 *And there were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went over Jordan before the king.* With him were a thousand men from Benjamin. And Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, with his fifteen sons and his twenty servants, rushed down to the Jordan before the king,
- 18 *And there went over a ferry boat to carry over the king's household, and to do what he thought good. And Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king, as he was come over Jordan;* They crossed the ford to bring over the king's household and to do his pleasure. And Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king, as he was about to cross the Jordan,
- 19 *And said unto the king, Let not my lord impute iniquity unto me, neither do thou remember that which thy servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart.* Said to the king, "Let not my lord hold me guilty or remember how your servant did wrong on the day my lord the king left Jerusalem. Let not the king take it to heart."

- 20 *For thy servant doth know that I have sinned: therefore, behold, I am come the first this day of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king.* For your servant knows that I have sinned. Therefore, see, I have come this day, the first of all the house of Joseph to come down to meet my lord the king."
- 21 *But Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered and said, Shall not Shimei be put to death for this, because he cursed the LORD'S anointed?* Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered, "Shall not Shimei be put to death for this, because he cursed the LORD's anointed?"
- 22 *And David said, What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah, that ye should this day be adversaries unto me? shall there any man be put to death this day in Israel? for do not I know that I am this day king over Israel?* But David said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah, that you should this day be as an adversary to me? Shall anyone be put to death in Israel this day? For do I not know that I am this day king over Israel?"
- 23 *Therefore the king said unto Shimei, Thou shalt not die. And the king sware unto him.* The king said to Shimei, "You shall not die." And the king gave him his oath.
- 24 *And Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king, and had neither dressed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came again in peace.* Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king. He had neither taken care of his feet nor trimmed his beard nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came back in safety.
- 25 *And it came to pass, when he was come to Jerusalem to meet the king, that the king said unto him, Wherefore wentest thou not with me, Mephibosheth?* When he came to Jerusalem to meet the king, the king said to him, "Why did you not go with me, Mephibosheth?"

- 26 *And he answered, My lord, O king, my servant deceived me: for thy servant said, I will saddle me an ass, that I may ride thereon, and go to the king; because thy servant is lame.* He answered, "My lord, O king, my servant deceived me, for your servant said to him, 'I will saddle a donkey for myself, that I may ride on it and go with the king.' For your servant is lame.
- 27 *And he hath slandered thy servant unto my lord the king; but my lord the king is as an angel of God: do therefore what is good in thine eyes.* He has slandered your servant to my lord the king. But my lord the king is like the angel of God; do therefore what seems good to you.
- 28 *For all of my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king: yet didst thou set thy servant among them that did eat at thine own table. What right therefore have I yet to cry any more unto the king?* For all my father's house were but men doomed to death before my lord the king, but you set your servant among those who eat at your table. What further right have I, then, to cry to the king?"
- 29 *And the king said unto him, Why speakest thou any more of thy matters? I have said, Thou and Ziba divide the land.* The king said to him, "Why speak any more of your affairs? I have decided: you and Ziba shall divide the land."
- 30 *And Mephibosheth said unto the king, Yea, let him take all, forasmuch as my lord the king is come again in peace unto his own house.* Mephibosheth said to the king, "Oh, let him take it all, since my lord the king has come safely home."
- 31 *And Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim, and went over Jordan with the king, to conduct him over Jordan.* Now Barzillai the Gileadite had come down from Rogelim. He went on with the king to the Jordan, to escort him over the Jordan.
- 32 *Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even fourscore years old: and he had provided the king of sustenance while he lay at Mahanaim; for he was a very great man.* Barzillai was a very aged man, eighty years old. He had provided the king with food while he stayed at Mahanaim, for he was a very wealthy man.

- 33 *And the king said unto Barzillai, Come thou over with me, and I will feed thee with me in Jerusalem.* The king said to Barzillai, "Come over with me. I will provide for you with me in Jerusalem."
- 34 *And Barzillai said unto the king, How long have I to live, that I should go up with the king unto Jerusalem?* But Barzillai said to the king, "How many years have I still to live, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem?"
- 35 *I am this day fourscore years old: and can I discern between good and evil? can thy servant taste what I eat or what I drink? can I hear any more the voice of singing men and singing women? wherefore then should thy servant be yet a burden unto my lord the king?* I am this day eighty years old. Can I discern what is pleasant and what is not? Can your servant taste what he eats or what he drinks? Can I still listen to the voice of singing men and singing women? Why then should your servant be an added burden to my lord the king?
- 36 *Thy servant will go a little way over Jordan with the king: and why should the king recompense it me with such a reward?* Your servant will go a little way over the Jordan with the king. Why should the king repay me with such a reward?
- 37 *Let thy servant, I pray thee, turn back again, that I may die in mine own city, and be buried by the grave of my father and of my mother. But behold thy servant Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good unto thee.* Please let your servant turn back, that I may die in my own city near the grave of my father and my mother. But here is your servant Chimham. Let him go over with my lord the king, and do for him whatever seems good to you."
- 38 *And the king answered, Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good unto thee: and whatsoever thou shalt require of me, that will I do for thee.* The king answered, "Chimham shall go over with me. I will do for him whatever seems good to you. All that you desire of me I will do for you."
- 39 *And all the people went over Jordan. And when the king was come over, the king kissed Barzillai, and blessed him; and he returned unto his own place.* Then all the people went over the Jordan, and the king went over. And the king kissed Barzillai and blessed him. He returned to his own home.

- 40 *Then the king went on to Gilgal, and Chimham went on with him: and all the people of Judah conducted the king, and also half the people of Israel.* The king went on to Gilgal, and Chimham went on with him. All the people of Judah, and also half the people of Israel, brought the king on his way.
- 41 *And, behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said unto the king, Why have our brethren the men of Judah stolen thee away, and have brought the king, and his household, and all David's men with him, over Jordan?* Then all the men of Israel came to the king and said to the king, "Why have our brothers the men of Judah stolen you away and brought the king and his household over the Jordan. All David's men with him?"
- 42 *And all the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, Because the king is near of kin to us: wherefore then be ye angry for this matter? have we eaten at all of the king's cost? or hath he given us any gift?* All the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, "Because the king is our close relative. Why then are you angry over this matter? Have we eaten at all at the king's expense? Or has he given us any gift?"
- 43 *And the men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more right in David than ye: why then did ye despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king? And the words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.* The men of Israel answered the men of Judah, "We have ten shares in the king, and in David also we have more than you. Why then did you despise us? Were we not the first to speak of bringing back our king?" But the words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

v9 — 2 Sam 15:14

v13 — 2 Sam 17:25

v14 — Judg 20:1

v16 — 1 Kgs 2:8

v22 — 1 Sam 11:13; 2 Sam 16:10

v27 — 2 Sam 14:20; 2 Sam 14:17

v28 — 2 Sam 9:13

v31 — 1 Kgs 2:7

v32 — 1 Sam 25:2; Deut 34:7

v37 — Jer 41:17; 1 Kgs 2:7

v39 — Gen 31:55

v43 — Gal 5:20; 2 Sam 5:1

Chapter 20

Sheba the son of Bichri led a revolt against David, and the northern tribes followed him. Joab pursued Sheba to the city of Abel, where a wise woman persuaded the city to throw Sheba's head over the wall, ending the rebellion.

- 1 *And there happened to be there a man of Belial, whose name was Sheba, the son of Bichri, a Benjamite: and he blew a trumpet, and said, We have no part in David, neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: every man to his tents, O Israel.* Now there happened to be there a worthless man, whose name was Sheba, the son of Bichri, a Benjaminite. And he blew the trumpet and said, "We have no portion in David. We have no inheritance in the son of Jesse; every man to his tents, O Israel!"
- 2 *So every man of Israel went up from after David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri: but the men of Judah clave unto their king, from Jordan even to Jerusalem.* So all the men of Israel withdrew from David and followed Sheba the son of Bichri. But the men of Judah followed their king steadfastly from the Jordan to Jerusalem.
- 3 *And David came to his house at Jerusalem; and the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in ward, and fed them, but went not in unto them. So they were shut up unto the day of their death, living in widowhood.* David came to his house at Jerusalem. And the king took the ten concubines whom he had left to keep the house and put them in a house under guard and provided for them, but did not go in to them. So they were shut up until the day of their death, living as if in widowhood.

- 4 *Then said the king to Amasa, Assemble me the men of Judah within three days, and be thou here present.* Then the king said to Amasa, "Call the men of Judah together to me within three days, and be here yourself."
- 5 *So Amasa went to assemble the men of Judah: but he tarried longer than the set time which he had appointed him.* So Amasa went to summon Judah. But he delayed beyond the set time that had been appointed him.
- 6 *And David said to Abishai, Now shall Sheba the son of Bichri do us more harm than did Absalom: take thou thy lord's servants, and pursue after him, lest he get him fenced cities, and escape us.* David said to Abishai, "Now Sheba the son of Bichri will do us more harm than Absalom. Take your lord's servants and pursue him, lest he get himself to fortified cities and escape from us."
- 7 *And there went out after him Joab's men, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, and all the mighty men: and they went out of Jerusalem, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.* There went out after him Joab's men and the Cherethites and the Pelethites and all the mighty men. They went out from Jerusalem to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri.
- 8 *When they were at the great stone which is in Gibeon, Amasa went before them. And Joab's garment that he had put on was girded unto him, and upon it a girdle with a sword fastened upon his loins in the sheath thereof; and as he went forth it fell out.* When they were at the great stone that is in Gibeon, Amasa came to meet them. Now Joab was wearing a soldier's garment, and over it was a belt with a sword in its sheath fastened at his hip, and as he went forward it fell out.
- 9 *And Joab said to Amasa, Art thou in health, my brother? And Joab took Amasa by the beard with the right hand to kiss him.* Joab said to Amasa, "Is it well with you, my brother?" And Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him.

- 10 *But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand: so he smote him therewith in the fifth rib, and shed out his bowels to the ground, and struck him not again; and he died. So Joab and Abishai his brother pursued after Sheba the son of Bichri.* But Amasa did not notice the sword that was in Joab's hand. And Joab struck him with it in the stomach and spilled his entrails to the ground without striking a second blow. He died. Then Joab and Abishai his brother pursued Sheba the son of Bichri.
- 11 *And one of Joab's men stood by him, and said, He that favoureth Joab, and he that is for David, let him go after Joab.* One of Joab's young men took his stand beside Amasa and said, "Whoever favors Joab, and whoever is for David, let him follow Joab."
- 12 *And Amasa wallowed in blood in the midst of the highway. And when the man saw that all the people stood still, he removed Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a cloth upon him, when he saw that every one that came by him stood still.* Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the highway. And the man saw that all the people stopped. So he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field and threw a garment over him, when he saw that everyone who came by him stopped.
- 13 *When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.* When he was taken out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri.
- 14 *And he went through all the tribes of Israel unto Abel, and to Bethmaachah, and all the Berites: and they were gathered together, and went also after him.* Sheba passed through all the tribes of Israel to Abel of Beth-maacah. All the Berites assembled and followed him in.
- 15 *And they came and besieged him in Abel of Bethmaachah, and they cast up a bank against the city, and it stood in the trench: and all the people that were with Joab battered the wall, to throw it down.* All the men who were with Joab came and besieged him in Abel of Beth-maacah. They cast up a mound against the city. It stood against the rampart. They were battering the wall to throw it down.

- 16 *Then cried a wise woman out of the city, Hear, hear; say, I pray you, unto Joab, Come near hither, that I may speak with thee.* Then a wise woman called from the city, "Listen! Listen! Tell Joab, 'Come here, that I may speak to you.' "
- 17 *And when he was come near unto her, the woman said, Art thou Joab? And he answered, I am he. Then she said unto him, Hear the words of thine handmaid. And he answered, I do hear.* He came near her, and the woman said, "Are you Joab?" He answered, "I am." Then she said to him, "Listen to the words of your servant." And he answered, "I am listening."
- 18 *Then she spake, saying, They were wont to speak in old time, saying, They shall surely ask counsel at Abel: and so they ended the matter.* Then she said, "They used to say in former times, 'Let them but ask counsel at Abel,' and so they settled a matter."
- 19 *I am one of them that are peaceable and faithful in Israel: thou seekest to destroy a city and a mother in Israel: why wilt thou swallow up the inheritance of the LORD?* I am one of those who are peaceable and faithful in Israel. You seek to destroy a city that is a mother in Israel. Why will You swallow up the heritage of the LORD?"
- 20 *And Joab answered and said, Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy.* Joab answered, "Far be it from me, far be it, that I should swallow up or destroy!"
- 21 *The matter is not so: but a man of mount Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri by name, hath lifted up his hand against the king, even against David: deliver him only, and I will depart from the city. And the woman said unto Joab, Behold, his head shall be thrown to thee over the wall.* That is not true. But a man of the hill country of Ephraim, called Sheba the son of Bichri, has lifted up his hand against King David. Give up him alone. I will withdraw from the city." And the woman said to Joab, "See, his head shall be thrown to you over the wall."

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| <p>22 <i>Then the woman went unto all the people in her wisdom. And they cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and cast it out to Joab. And he blew a trumpet, and they retired from the city, every man to his tent. And Joab returned to Jerusalem unto the king.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Now Joab was over all the host of Israel: and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites:</i></p> <p>24 <i>And Adoram was over the tribute: and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder:</i></p> <p>25 <i>And Sheva was scribe: and Zadok and Abiathar were the priests:</i></p> <p>26 <i>And Ira also the Jairite was a chief ruler about David.</i></p> | <p>Then the woman went to all the people in her wisdom. And they cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri and threw it out to Joab. So he blew the trumpet. They dispersed from the city, every man to his home. And Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.</p> <p>Now Joab was in command of all the army of Israel. Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was in command of the Cherethites and the Pelethites;</p> <p>Adoram was in charge of the forced labor. Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was the recorder;</p> <p>Sheva was secretary. Zadok and Abiathar were priests;</p> <p>Ira the Jairite was also a chief ruler about David.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Abel (AY-bel) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Kgs 12:16
- v3 — 2 Sam 16:21-22; 2 Sam 15:16
- v4 — 2 Sam 19:13; 2 Sam 17:25
- v7 — 2 Sam 8:18
- v10 — 2 Sam 2:23
- v15 — 2 Kgs 19:32
- v16 — 2 Sam 14:2
- v19 — 1 Sam 26:19
- v23 — 2 Sam 8:16-18

Chapter 21

A three-year famine struck because Saul had broken Israel's oath to the Gibeonites, and David gave seven of Saul's descendants to be executed. David's mighty men killed several Philistine

giants, including the brother of Goliath.

- 1 *Then there was a famine in the days of David three years, year after year; and David enquired of the LORD. And the LORD answered, It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he slew the Gibeonites.*

Now there was a famine in the days of David for three years, year after year. And David sought the face of the LORD. And the LORD said, "There is bloodguilt on Saul and on his house, because he put the Gibeonites to death."
- 2 *And the king called the Gibeonites, and said unto them; (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites; and the children of Israel had sworn unto them: and Saul sought to slay them in his zeal to the children of Israel and Judah.)*

So the king called the Gibeonites and spoke to them. Now the Gibeonites were not of the people of Israel but of the remnant of the Amorites. Although the people of Israel had sworn to spare them, Saul had sought to strike them down in his zeal for the people of Israel and Judah.
- 3 *Wherefore David said unto the Gibeonites, What shall I do for you? and wherewith shall I make the atonement, that ye may bless the inheritance of the LORD?*

David said to the Gibeonites, "What shall I do for You? And how shall I make atonement, that You may bless the heritage of the LORD?"
- 4 *And the Gibeonites said unto him, We will have no silver nor gold of Saul, nor of his house; neither for us shalt thou kill any man in Israel. And he said, What ye shall say, that will I do for you.*

The Gibeonites said to him, "It is not a matter of silver or gold between us and Saul or his house; neither is it for us to put any man to death in Israel." And he said, "What do you say that I shall do for you?"
- 5 *And they answered the king, The man that consumed us, and that devised against us that we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the coasts of Israel,*

They said to the king, "The man who consumed us and planned to destroy us, so that we should have no place in all the territory of Israel,

- 6 *Let seven men of his sons be delivered unto us, and we will hang them up unto the LORD in Gibeah of Saul, whom the LORD did choose. And the king said, I will give them.* Let seven of His sons be given to us, so that we may hang them before the LORD at Gibeah of Saul, the chosen of the LORD." And the king said, "I will give them."
- 7 *But the king spared Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the LORD'S oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul.* But the king spared Mephibosheth, the son of Saul's son Jonathan, because of the oath of the LORD that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul.
- 8 *But the king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bare unto Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth; and the five sons of Michal the daughter of Saul, whom she brought up for Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholathite:* The king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bore to Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth. The five sons of Michal the daughter of Saul, whom she brought up for Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholathite;
- 9 *And he delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites, and they hanged them in the hill before the LORD: and they fell all seven together, and were put to death in the days of harvest, in the first days, in the beginning of barley harvest.* He gave them into the hands of the Gibeonites. They hanged them on the mountain before the LORD, and the seven of them perished together. They were put to death in the first days of harvest, at the beginning of the barley harvest.
- 10 *And Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth, and spread it for her upon the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water dropped upon them out of heaven, and suffered neither the birds of the air to rest on them by day, nor the beasts of the field by night.* Then Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth and spread it for herself on the rock, from the beginning of harvest until rain fell upon them from the heavens. And she did not allow the birds of the air to come upon them by day, or the wild animals by night.
- 11 *And it was told David what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done.* When David was told what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done,

- 12 *And David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabeshgilead, which had stolen them from the street of Bethshan, where the Philistines had hanged them, when the Philistines had slain Saul in Gilboa:* David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of his son Jonathan from the men of Jabesh-gilead, who had stolen them from the public square of Beth-shan, where the Philistines had hanged them, on the day the Philistines killed Saul on Gilboa.
- 13 *And he brought up from thence the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son; and they gathered the bones of them that were hanged.* He brought up from there the bones of Saul and the bones of his son Jonathan. They gathered the bones of those who were hanged.
- 14 *And the bones of Saul and Jonathan his son buried they in the country of Benjamin in Zelah, in the sepulchre of Kish his father: and they performed all that the king commanded. And after that God was intreated for the land.* They buried the bones of Saul and his son Jonathan in the land of Benjamin in Zela, in the tomb of Kish his father. And they did all that the king commanded. And after that God responded to the plea for the land.
- 15 *Moreover the Philistines had yet war again with Israel; and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines: and David waxed faint.* There was war again between the Philistines and Israel. And David went down together with his servants. They fought against the Philistines. And David grew weary.
- 16 *And Ishbibenob, which was of the sons of the giant, the weight of whose spear weighed three hundred shekels of brass in weight, he being girded with a new sword, thought to have slain David.* Ishbi-benob, one of the descendants of the giants, whose spear weighed three hundred shekels of bronze, and who was armed with a new sword, thought to kill David.

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| <p>17 <i>But Abishai the son of Zeruiah succoured him, and smote the Philistine, and killed him. Then the men of David sware unto him, saying, Thou shalt go no more out with us to battle, that thou quench not the light of Israel.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And it came to pass after this, that there was again a battle with the Philistines at Gob: then Sibbechai the Hushathite slew Saph, which was of the sons of the giant.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And there was again a battle in Gob with the Philistines, where Elhanan the son of Jaareoregim, a Bethlehemite, slew the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And there was yet a battle in Gath, where was a man of great stature, that had on every hand six fingers, and on every foot six toes, four and twenty in number; and he also was born to the giant.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimeah the brother of David slew him.</i></p> <p>22 <i>These four were born to the giant in Gath, and fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants.</i></p> | <p>But Abishai the son of Zeruiah came to his aid and attacked the Philistine and killed him. Then David's men swore to him, "You shall no longer go out with us to battle, lest you quench the lamp of Israel."</p> <p>After this there was again war with the Philistines at Gob. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite struck down Saph, who was one of the descendants of the giants.</p> <p>There was again war with the Philistines at Gob, and Elhanan the son of Jaare-oregim, the Bethlehemite, struck down the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.</p> <p>There was again war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, who had six fingers on each hand, and six toes on each foot, twenty-four in number. He also was descended from the giants.</p> <p>When he taunted Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimeah, David's brother, struck him down.</p> <p>These four were descended from the giants in Gath. They fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Goliath (*go-LY-ath*) — The Philistine giant from Gath — over nine feet tall; defeated by the young David with a stone and sling; symbol of enemies too great for human strength.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 7:11-12
- v6 — 1 Sam 10:24
- v7 — 1 Sam 18:3; 1 Sam 23:18; 2 Sam 4:4; 1 Sam 20:15
- v8 — 2 Sam 3:7; 1 Sam 18:19
- v10 — Deut 21:23
- v12 — 1 Sam 31:10-13; Josh 17:11
- v14 — Josh 18:28
- v17 — 1 Kgs 11:36; 2 Sam 18:3
- v18 — 1 Chr 11:29
- v22 — 1 Chr 20:8

Chapter 22

David sang a psalm of deliverance to the LORD, celebrating God as his rock, fortress, and shield. He recounted how God rescued him from all his enemies and from the hand of Saul.

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| <p>1 <i>And David spake unto the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD had delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul:</i></p> | <p>David spoke to the LORD the words of this song on the day when the LORD delivered Him from the hand of all His enemies, and from the hand of Saul.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he said, The LORD is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer;</i></p> | <p>He said, "The LORD is my rock and my fortress and my deliverer;</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The God of my rock; in him will I trust: he is my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge, my saviour; thou savest me from violence.</i></p> | <p>My God, my rock, in whom I take refuge, my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my stronghold and my refuge, my savior; You save me from violence.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>I will call on the LORD, who is worthy to be praised: so shall I be saved from mine enemies.</i></p> | <p>I call upon the LORD, Who is worthy to be praised. I am saved from my enemies.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>When the waves of death compassed me, the floods of ungodly men made me afraid;</i></p> | <p>For the waves of death encompassed me, the floods of ungodly men assailed me;</p> |

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| 6 <i>The sorrows of hell compassed me about; the snares of death prevented me;</i> | The cords of hell entangled me; the snares of death confronted me. |
| 7 <i>In my distress I called upon the LORD, and cried to my God: and he did hear my voice out of his temple, and my cry did enter into his ears.</i> | In my distress I called upon the LORD; to my God I called. From His temple He heard my voice, and my cry came to His ears. |
| 8 <i>Then the earth shook and trembled; the foundations of heaven moved and shook, because he was wroth.</i> | Then the earth reeled and rocked; the foundations of the heavens trembled and quaked, because He was angry. |
| 9 <i>There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.</i> | Smoke went up from his nostrils, and devouring fire from His mouth; glowing coals flamed forth from Him. |
| 10 <i>He bowed the heavens also, and came down; and darkness was under his feet.</i> | He bowed the heavens and came down; thick darkness was under His feet. |
| 11 <i>And he rode upon a cherub, and did fly: and he was seen upon the wings of the wind.</i> | He rode on a cherub and flew; He was seen on the wings of the wind. |
| 12 <i>And he made darkness pavilions round about him, dark waters, and thick clouds of the skies.</i> | He made darkness around Him His canopy, thick clouds, a gathering of water. |
| 13 <i>Through the brightness before him were coals of fire kindled.</i> | Out of the brightness before Him coals of fire flamed forth. |
| 14 <i>The LORD thundered from heaven, and the most High uttered his voice.</i> | The LORD thundered from heaven, and the Most High uttered His voice. |
| 15 <i>And he sent out arrows, and scattered them; lightning, and discomfited them.</i> | He sent out arrows and scattered them; lightning, and routed them. |
| 16 <i>And the channels of the sea appeared, the foundations of the world were discovered, at the rebuking of the LORD, at the blast of the breath of his nostrils.</i> | Then the channels of the sea were seen; the foundations of the world were laid bare, at the rebuke of the LORD, at the blast of the breath of his nostrils. |

- 17 *He sent from above, he took me; he drew me out of many waters;* He sent from on high, He took me; He drew me out of many waters.
- 18 *He delivered me from my strong enemy, and from them that hated me: for they were too strong for me.* He rescued me from my strong enemy, from those who hated me, for they were too mighty for me.
- 19 *They prevented me in the day of my calamity: but the LORD was my stay.* They confronted me in the day of my calamity. But the LORD was my support.
- 20 *He brought me forth also into a large place: he delivered me, because he delighted in me.* He brought me out into a broad place; He rescued me, because He delighted in me.
- 21 *The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness: according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.* The LORD dealt with me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands He rewarded me.
- 22 *For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.* For I have kept the ways of the LORD and have not wickedly departed from my God.
- 23 *For all his judgments were before me: and as for his statutes, I did not depart from them.* For all His rules were before me, and from His statutes I did not turn aside.
- 24 *I was also upright before him, and have kept myself from mine iniquity.* I was blameless before Him. I kept myself from iniquity.
- 25 *Therefore the LORD hath recompensed me according to my righteousness; according to my cleanness in his eye sight.* The LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, according to my cleanness in His sight.
- 26 *With the merciful thou wilt shew thyself merciful, and with the upright man thou wilt shew thyself upright.* With the merciful You show Yourself merciful; with the blameless man You show Yourself blameless;
- 27 *With the pure thou wilt shew thyself pure; and with the froward thou wilt shew thyself unsavoury.* With the pure You show Yourself pure, and with the crooked You make Yourself seem tortuous.

- 28 *And the afflicted people thou wilt save: but thine eyes are upon the haughty, that thou mayest bring them down.* You save a humble people, but Your eyes are on the haughty to bring them down.
- 29 *For thou art my lamp, O LORD: and the LORD will lighten my darkness.* For You are my lamp, O LORD, and my God lightens my darkness.
- 30 *For by thee I have run through a troop: by my God have I leaped over a wall.* For by You I can run against a troop, and by my God I can leap over a wall.
- 31 *As for God, his way is perfect; the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all them that trust in him.* This God—His way is perfect; the word of the LORD proves true; He is a shield for all those who take refuge in Him.
- 32 *For who is God, save the LORD? and who is a rock, save our God?* For who is God. But the LORD? And who is a rock, except our God?
- 33 *God is my strength and power: and he maketh my way perfect.* This God is my strong refuge and has made my way blameless.
- 34 *He maketh my feet like hinds' feet: and setteth me upon my high places.* He made my feet like the feet of a deer and set me secure on the heights.
- 35 *He teacheth my hands to war; so that a bow of steel is broken by mine arms.* He trains my hands for war, so that my arms can bend a bow of bronze.
- 36 *Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy gentleness hath made me great.* You have given me the shield of Your salvation, and Your help made me great.
- 37 *Thou hast enlarged my steps under me; so that my feet did not slip.* You gave a wide place for my steps under me, and my feet did not slip.
- 38 *I have pursued mine enemies, and destroyed them; and turned not again until I had consumed them.* I pursued my enemies and destroyed them, and did not turn back until they were consumed.
- 39 *And I have consumed them, and wounded them, that they could not arise: yea, they are fallen under my feet.* I consumed them; I thrust them through, so that they did not rise; they fell under my feet.

- 40 *For thou hast girded me with strength to battle: them that rose up against me hast thou subdued under me.* For You equipped me with strength for the battle; You made those who rise against me sink under me.
- 41 *Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies, that I might destroy them that hate me.* You made my enemies turn their backs to me, those who hated me. I destroyed them.
- 42 *They looked, but there was none to save; even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.* They looked, but there was none to save; they cried to the LORD. But He did not answer them.
- 43 *Then did I beat them as small as the dust of the earth, I did stamp them as the mire of the street, and did spread them abroad.* I beat them fine as the dust of the earth; I crushed them and stamped them down like the mire of the streets.
- 44 *Thou also hast delivered me from the strivings of my people, thou hast kept me to be head of the heathen: a people which I knew not shall serve me.* You delivered me from strife with my people; You kept me as the head of the nations; people whom I had not known served me.
- 45 *Strangers shall submit themselves unto me: as soon as they hear, they shall be obedient unto me.* Foreigners came cringing to me; as soon as they heard of me, they obeyed me.
- 46 *Strangers shall fade away, and they shall be afraid out of their close places.* Foreigners lost heart and came trembling out of their strongholds.
- 47 *The LORD liveth; and blessed be my rock; and exalted be the God of the rock of my salvation.* The LORD lives, and blessed be my rock, and exalted be my God, the rock of my salvation,
- 48 *It is God that avengeth me, and that bringeth down the people under me.* The God Who gave me vengeance and brought down peoples under me,
- 49 *And that bringeth me forth from mine enemies: thou also hast lifted me up on high above them that rose up against me: thou hast delivered me from the violent man.* Who brought me out from my enemies; You exalted me above those who rose against me; You delivered me from men of violence.

- 50 *Therefore I will give thanks unto thee, O LORD, among the heathen, and I will sing praises unto thy name.* For this I will praise You, O LORD, among the nations, and sing praises to your name.
- 51 *He is the tower of salvation for his king; and sheweth mercy to his anointed, unto David, and to his seed for evermore.* Great salvation he brings to his king, and shows mercy to his anointed, to David and his seed forever."

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Saul (SAWL) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v2** — Ps 18:2-50; Ps 31:3; Ps 71:3
v3 — Ps 9:9; Isa 12:2; Prov 18:10; Prov 30:5; Ps 18:2
v7 — Ps 18:6; Jonah 2:7; Ps 116:4; Ex 3:7; Ps 34:15-17
v8 — Job 26:11; Ps 97:4; Ps 77:18; Judg 5:4
v17 — Isa 43:2; Ps 144:7; Ps 18:16; Ps 130:1; Ps 32:6
v20 — Ps 31:8; 2 Sam 15:26; Ps 118:5; Ps 149:4; Ps 22:8
v29 — Ps 27:1; John 8:12; Rev 21:23; John 12:46; Job 29:3
v30 — Ps 18:29; Phil 4:13; Ps 118:10-12; Rom 8:37
v31 — Deut 32:4; Prov 30:5; Ps 18:30; Ps 12:6; Matt 5:48
v33 — Eph 6:10; Isa 41:10; Ps 27:1; Phil 4:13; Ps 28:7-8
v34 — Isa 58:14; Deut 32:13; Hab 3:19; 2 Sam 2:18
v51 — Ps 144:10; Ps 89:29; Ps 89:20; 2 Sam 7:12-13; Ps 18:50

Chapter 23

David spoke his last words, declaring that the Spirit of the LORD spoke through him. The names and exploits of David's mighty men are listed, including the three who broke through the Philistine lines to bring water from the well of Bethlehem.

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| 1 | <i>Now these be the last words of David. David the son of Jesse said, and the man who was raised up on high, the anointed of the God of Jacob, and the sweet psalmist of Israel, said,</i> | Now these are the last words of David: The oracle of David, the son of Jesse, the oracle of the man who was raised on high, the anointed of the God of Jacob, the sweet psalmist of Israel: |
| 2 | <i>The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue.</i> | "The Spirit of the LORD speaks by me; His word is on my tongue. |
| 3 | <i>The God of Israel said, the Rock of Israel spake to me, He that ruleth over men must be just, ruling in the fear of God.</i> | The God of Israel has spoken; the Rock of Israel has said to me: When one rules justly over men, ruling in the fear of God, |
| 4 | <i>And he shall be as the light of the morning, when the sun riseth, even a morning without clouds; as the tender grass springing out of the earth by clear shining after rain.</i> | He dawns on them like the morning light, like the sun shining forth on a cloudless morning, like rain that makes grass to sprout from the earth. |
| 5 | <i>Although my house be not so with God; yet he hath made with me an everlasting covenant, ordered in all things, and sure: for this is all my salvation, and all my desire, although he make it not to grow.</i> | Although my house be not so with God, yet He hath made with me an everlasting covenant, ordered in all things and sure. For this is all my salvation and all my desire, although He make it not to grow. |
| 6 | <i>But the sons of Belial shall be all of them as thorns thrust away, because they cannot be taken with hands:</i> | But worthless men are all like thorns that are thrown away, for they cannot be taken with the hand; |
| 7 | <i>But the man that shall touch them must be fenced with iron and the staff of a spear; and they shall be utterly burned with fire in the same place.</i> | The man who touches them arms himself with iron and the shaft of a spear. They are utterly consumed with fire in their place." |

- 8 *These be the names of the mighty men whom David had: The Tachmonite that sat in the seat, chief among the captains; the same was Adino the Eznite: he lift up his spear against eight hundred, whom he slew at one time.* These are the names of the mighty men whom David had: The Tachmonite that sat in the seat, chief among the captains; the same was Adino the Eznite. He raised his spear against eight hundred, whom he killed at one time.
- 9 *And after him was Eleazar the son of Dodo the Ahohite, one of the three mighty men with David, when they defied the Philistines that were there gathered together to battle, and the men of Israel were gone away:* Next to him among the three mighty men was Eleazar the son of Dodo, son of Ahohi. He was with David when they defied the Philistines who were gathered there for battle, and the men of Israel withdrew.
- 10 *He arose, and smote the Philistines until his hand was weary, and his hand clave unto the sword: and the LORD wrought a great victory that day; and the people returned after him only to spoil.* He rose and struck down the Philistines until His hand was weary. His hand clung to the sword. And the LORD brought about a great victory that day, and the men returned after Him only to strip the slain.
- 11 *And after him was Shammah the son of Agee the Hararite. And the Philistines were gathered together into a troop, where was a piece of ground full of lentiles: and the people fled from the Philistines.* Next to Him was Shammah, the son of Agee the Hararite. The Philistines gathered together at Lehi, where there was a plot of ground full of lentils, and the men fled from the Philistines.
- 12 *But he stood in the midst of the ground, and defended it, and slew the Philistines: and the LORD wrought a great victory.* But He took His stand in the midst of the plot and defended it and struck down the Philistines. The LORD worked a great victory.
- 13 *And three of the thirty chief went down, and came to David in the harvest time unto the cave of Adullam: and the troop of the Philistines pitched in the valley of Rephaim.* Three of the thirty chief men went down and came about harvest time to David at the cave of Adullam, when a band of Philistines was encamped in the Valley of Rephaim.

- 14 *And David was then in an hold, and the garrison of the Philistines was then in Bethlehem.* David was then in the stronghold, and the garrison of the Philistines was then at Bethlehem.
- 15 *And David longed, and said, Oh that one would give me drink of the water of the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate!* David said longingly, "Oh, that someone would give me water to drink from the well of Bethlehem that is by the gate!"
- 16 *And the three mighty men brake through the host of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem, that was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David: nevertheless he would not drink thereof, but poured it out unto the LORD.* Then the three mighty men broke through the camp of the Philistines and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem that was by the gate and carried and brought it to David. But he would not drink of it. He poured it out to the LORD
- 17 *And he said, Be it far from me, O LORD, that I should do this: is not this the blood of the men that went in jeopardy of their lives? therefore he would not drink it. These things did these three mighty men.* Said, "Far be it from me, O LORD, that I should do this. Shall I drink the blood of the men who went at the risk of their lives?" Therefore He would not drink it. These things the three mighty men did.
- 18 *And Abishai, the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was chief among three. And he lifted up his spear against three hundred, and slew them, and had the name among three.* Now Abishai the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was chief among three. And He wielded his spear against three hundred men and killed them and won a name among the three.
- 19 *Was he not most honourable of three? therefore he was their captain: howbeit he attained not unto the first three.* He was the most renowned of the three and became their commander. But He did not attain to the first three.

- 20 *And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man, of Kabzeel, who had done many acts, he slew two lionlike men of Moab: he went down also and slew a lion in the midst of a pit in time of snow:* Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was a valiant man of Kabzeel, a doer of great deeds. He struck down two heroes of Moab. He also went down and struck down a lion in a pit on a day when snow had fallen.
- 21 *And he slew an Egyptian, a goodly man: and the Egyptian had a spear in his hand; but he went down to him with a staff, and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and slew him with his own spear.* He struck down an Egyptian, a handsome man. The Egyptian had a spear in His hand, but Benaiah went down to him with a staff and snatched the spear out of the Egyptian's hand and killed Him with His own spear.
- 22 *These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and had the name among three mighty men.* These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and won a name beside the three mighty men.
- 23 *He was more honourable than the thirty, but he attained not to the first three. And David set him over his guard.* He was renowned among the thirty. But he did not attain to the three. And David set him over his bodyguard.
- 24 *Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty; Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,* Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty; Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,
- 25 *Shammah the Harodite, Elikah the Harodite,* Shammah of Harod, Elikah of Harod,
- 26 *Helez the Paltite, Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite,* Helez the Paltite, Ira the son of Ikkesh of Tekoa,
- 27 *Abiezer the Anethothite, Mebunnai the Hushathite,* Abiezer of Anathoth, Mebunnai the Hushathite,
- 28 *Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite,* Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai of Netophah,
- 29 *Heleb the son of Baanah, a Netophathite, Ittai the son of Ribai out of Gibeah of the children of Benjamin,* Heleb the son of Baanah of Netophah, Ittai the son of Ribai of Gibeah of the people of Benjamin,

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| 30 | <i>Benaiah the Pirathonite, Hiddai of the brooks of Gaash,</i> | Benaiah of Pirathon, Hiddai of the brooks of Gaash, |
| 31 | <i>Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth the Barhumite,</i> | Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth of Bahurim, |
| 32 | <i>Eliahba the Shaalbonite, of the sons of Jashen, Jonathan,</i> | Eliahba the Shaalbonite, the sons of Jashen, Jonathan, |
| 33 | <i>Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam the son of Sharar the Hararite,</i> | Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam the son of Sharar the Hararite, |
| 34 | <i>Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai, the son of the Maachathite, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the Gilonite,</i> | Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai of Maacah, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the Gilonite, |
| 35 | <i>Hezrai the Carmelite, Paarai the Arbite,</i> | Hezrai of Carmel, Paarai the Arbite, |
| 36 | <i>Igal the son of Nathan of Zobah, Bani the Gadite,</i> | Igal the son of Nathan of Zobah, Bani the Gadite, |
| 37 | <i>Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Beerothite, armourbearer to Joab the son of Zeruiah,</i> | Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai of Beeroth, the armor-bearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah, |
| 38 | <i>Ira an Ithrite, Gareb an Ithrite,</i> | Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite, |
| 39 | <i>Uriah the Hittite: thirty and seven in all.</i> | Uriah the Hittite: thirty-seven in all. |

Words in this chapter:

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Sam 16:12-13; Ps 89:20; 2 Sam 7:8-9; Ps 78:70-71; Col 3:16
- v2** — 2 Pet 1:21; Matt 22:43; Mark 12:36; Acts 2:25-31; Heb 3:7-8
- v3** — Deut 32:4; 2 Sam 22:32; Ex 18:21; Ps 72:2; Zech 9:9
- v4** — Judg 5:31
- v5** — Isa 55:3; Isa 9:6-7; 2 Sam 7:14-16; Jer 32:40; Ps 89:28-29
- v6** — Ezek 2:6
- v7** — Heb 6:8
- v9** — 1 Chr 27:4; 1 Chr 11:12-14
- v13** — 2 Sam 5:18; 1 Sam 22:1

v14 — 1 Sam 22:4-5

v15 — John 4:14

v16 — Gen 35:14; 2 Cor 5:14

Chapter 24

David sinned by numbering the people, and God sent a plague that killed 70,000 men in Israel. David purchased the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite and built an altar there, and the plague was stopped.

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| 1 | <i>And again the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel, and he moved David against them to say, Go, number Israel and Judah.</i> | Again the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He incited David against them, saying, "Go, number Israel and Judah." |
| 2 | <i>For the king said to Joab the captain of the host, which was with him, Go now through all the tribes of Israel, from Dan even to Beersheba, and number ye the people, that I may know the number of the people.</i> | So the king said to Joab, the commander of the army, who was with him, "Go through all the tribes of Israel, from Dan to Beersheba, and number the people, that I may know the number of the people." |
| 3 | <i>And Joab said unto the king, Now the LORD thy God add unto the people, how many soever they be, an hundredfold, and that the eyes of my lord the king may see it: but why doth my lord the king delight in this thing?</i> | But Joab said to the king, "May the LORD your God add to the people a hundred times as many as they are, while the eyes of my lord the king still see it, but why does my lord the king delight in this thing?" |
| 4 | <i>Notwithstanding the king's word prevailed against Joab, and against the captains of the host. And Joab and the captains of the host went out from the presence of the king, to number the people of Israel.</i> | But the king's word prevailed against Joab and the commanders of the army. So Joab and the commanders of the army went out from the presence of the king to number the people of Israel. |
| 5 | <i>And they passed over Jordan, and pitched in Aroer, on the right side of the city that lieth in the midst of the river of Gad, and toward Jazer:</i> | They crossed the Jordan and began from Aroer, and from the city that is in the middle of the valley, toward Gad and on to Jazer. |

- 6 *Then they came to Gilead, and to the land of Tahtimhodshi; and they came to Danjaan, and about to Zidon,* Then they came to Gilead, and to Kadesh in the land of the Hittites. They came to Dan, and from Dan they went around to Sidon,
- 7 *And came to the strong hold of Tyre, and to all the cities of the Hivites, and of the Canaanites: and they went out to the south of Judah, even to Beersheba.* Came to the fortress of Tyre and to all the cities of the Hivites and Canaanites. They went out to the south of Judah at Beersheba.
- 8 *So when they had gone through all the land, they came to Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days.* So when they had gone through all the land, they came to Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days.
- 9 *And Joab gave up the sum of the number of the people unto the king: and there were in Israel eight hundred thousand valiant men that drew the sword; and the men of Judah were five hundred thousand men.* Joab gave the sum of the number of the people to the king: in Israel there were 800,000 valiant men who drew the sword, and the men of Judah were 500,000.
- 10 *And David's heart smote him after that he had numbered the people. And David said unto the LORD, I have sinned greatly in that I have done: and now, I beseech thee, O LORD, take away the iniquity of thy servant; for I have done very foolishly.* But David's heart struck him after he had numbered the people. And David said to the LORD, "I have sinned greatly in what I have done. But now, O LORD, please take away the iniquity of Your servant, for I have done very foolishly."
- 11 *For when David was up in the morning, the word of the LORD came unto the prophet Gad, David's seer, saying,* When David arose in the morning, the word of the LORD came to the prophet Gad, David's seer, saying,
- 12 *Go and say unto David, Thus saith the LORD, I offer thee three things; choose thee one of them, that I may do it unto thee.* "Go and say to David, 'Thus says the LORD, Three things I offer You. Choose one of them, that I may do it to You.' "

- 13 *So Gad came to David, and told him, and said unto him, Shall seven years of famine come unto thee in thy land? or wilt thou flee three months before thine enemies, while they pursue thee? or that there be three days' pestilence in thy land? now advise, and see what answer I shall return to him that sent me.* So Gad came to David and told him, and said to him, "Shall seven years of famine come to you in your land? Or will you flee three months before your foes while they pursue you? Or shall there be three days' pestilence in your land? Now consider, and decide what answer I shall return to him who sent me."
- 14 *And David said unto Gad, I am in a great strait: let us fall now into the hand of the LORD; for his mercies are great: and let me not fall into the hand of man.* Then David said to Gad, "I am in great distress. Let us fall into the hand of the LORD, for His mercy is great; but let me not fall into the hand of man."
- 15 *So the LORD sent a pestilence upon Israel from the morning even to the time appointed: and there died of the people from Dan even to Beersheba seventy thousand men.* So the LORD sent a pestilence on Israel from the morning until the appointed time. And there died of the people from Dan to Beersheba 70,000 men.
- 16 *And when the angel stretched out his hand upon Jerusalem to destroy it, the LORD repented him of the evil, and said to the angel that destroyed the people, It is enough: stay now thine hand. And the angel of the LORD was by the threshingplace of Araunah the Jebusite.* When the angel stretched out his hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it, the LORD relented from the calamity and said to the angel who was working destruction among the people, "It is enough; now stay your hand." And the angel of the LORD was by the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite.
- 17 *And David spake unto the LORD when he saw the angel that smote the people, and said, Lo, I have sinned, and I have done wickedly: but these sheep, what have they done? let thine hand, I pray thee, be against me, and against my father's house.* Then David spoke to the LORD when He saw the angel who was striking the people, and said, "See, I have sinned. I have done wickedly. But these sheep, what have they done? Please let Your hand be against me and against my father's house."

- 18 *And Gad came that day to David, and said unto him, Go up, rear an altar unto the LORD in the threshingfloor of Araunah the Jebusite.* Gad came that day to David and said to him, "Go up, raise an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite."
- 19 *And David, according to the saying of Gad, went up as the LORD commanded.* So David went up at Gad's word, as the LORD commanded.
- 20 *And Araunah looked, and saw the king and his servants coming on toward him: and Araunah went out, and bowed himself before the king on his face upon the ground.* When Araunah looked down, he saw the king and his servants coming on toward him. And Araunah went out and paid homage to the king with his face to the ground.
- 21 *And Araunah said, Wherefore is my lord the king come to his servant? And David said, To buy the threshingfloor of thee, to build an altar unto the LORD, that the plague may be stayed from the people.* Araunah said, "Why has my lord the king come to his servant?" David said, "To buy the threshing floor from you, in order to build an altar to the LORD, that the plague may be averted from the people."
- 22 *And Araunah said unto David, Let my lord the king take and offer up what seemeth good unto him: behold, here be oxen for burnt sacrifice, and threshing instruments and other instruments of the oxen for wood.* Then Araunah said to David, "Let my lord the king take and offer up what seems good to him. Here are the oxen for the burnt offering and the threshing sledges and the yokes of the oxen for the wood.
- 23 *All these things did Araunah, as a king, give unto the king. And Araunah said unto the king, The LORD thy God accept thee.* All this, O king, Araunah gives to the king." And Araunah said to the king, "May the LORD your God accept you."
- 24 *And the king said unto Araunah, Nay; but I will surely buy it of thee at a price: neither will I offer burnt offerings unto the LORD my God of that which doth cost me nothing. So David bought the threshingfloor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.* But the king said to Araunah, "No. But I will buy it from You for a price. I will not offer burnt offerings to the LORD my God that cost me nothing." So David bought the threshing floor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.

- 25 *And David built there an altar unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So the LORD was intreated for the land, and the plague was stayed from Israel.* David built there an altar to the LORD and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So the LORD responded to the plea for the land, and the plague was averted from Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 21:1; 1 Chr 27:23-24; Jas 1:13-14
- v2 — 2 Sam 3:10
- v5 — Josh 13:9; Deut 2:36
- v6 — Josh 19:28
- v10 — 2 Sam 12:13; 1 Sam 13:13; Prov 28:13
- v11 — 1 Sam 22:5; 1 Sam 9:9
- v14 — Ps 119:156; Ps 51:1; 1 Chr 21:13
- v16 — Ex 12:23; Joel 2:13-14
- v17 — Ps 74:1; 1 Chr 21:16-17
- v22 — 1 Kgs 19:21
- v23 — Ezek 20:40-41
- v24 — 1 Chr 21:24-25; Mal 1:12-14; Gen 23:13

1 Kings

Author: Unknown — Jewish tradition names Jeremiah, but the book draws on royal annals, temple records, and prophetic accounts compiled by unnamed authors over generations.

Date written: Final compilation c. 560 BC, during or shortly after the Babylonian exile.

Written to: The exiled nation, to trace the history of Israel's monarchy from its height to its collapse.

Setting: 1 Kings opens at David's deathbed and covers roughly four centuries — Solomon's golden reign, the kingdom's division after his death, and the spiraling decline of both Israel and Judah.

Where this sits historically: c. 970–850 BC — Solomon's reign, the kingdom's split in 930 BC, and the divided monarchy through Ahab's death; Egypt's 22nd dynasty under Shishak invades Judah in 925 BC.

Contemporaries: Hiram I of Tyre; Shishak of Egypt; the Aramean kings Ben-Hadad I and II; the prophets Elijah and Micaiah. 2 Chronicles retells the Judah side of this same era.

Big themes:

- Wisdom and its limits — Solomon's wisdom is unmatched, but it cannot save him from the idolatry his foreign wives bring in
- The temple — its construction and dedication occupy the center of the book; it is the place where God's name dwells
- The divided kingdom — the ten northern tribes break away under Jeroboam, and Israel is never reunited in the OT
- Elijah — his sudden appearance in chapter 17 dominates the latter half; he confronts Ahab, Jezebel, and the prophets of Baal
- Covenant faithfulness as the measure of every king — each king is judged by one standard: did he walk as David walked?

Key passages: 1 Kgs 3:9; 8:27–30; 11:11; 17:1; 18:39

How it fits: 1 Kings is the direct sequel to 2 Samuel. It shows what happens when the covenant is kept (Solomon's early reign) and what happens when it is broken (the division, Jeroboam's golden calves, Ahab's reign). The prophetic ministries of Elijah and Elisha that dominate 1–2 Kings are the background against which Isaiah and the later prophets preach.

Chapter 1

King David was old and feeble, and his son Adonijah attempted to seize the throne with the support of Joab and Abiathar. Bathsheba and Nathan intervened, and David ordered Solomon to be anointed king at Gihon; Adonijah's supporters scattered.

- 1 *Now king David was old and stricken in years; and they covered him with clothes, but he gat no heat.* Now King David was old and advanced in years. And although they covered him with clothes, he could not get warm.
- 2 *Wherefore his servants said unto him, Let there be sought for my lord the king a young virgin: and let her stand before the king, and let her cherish him, and let her lie in thy bosom, that my lord the king may get heat.* Therefore his servants said to him, "Let a young woman be sought for my lord the king, and let her wait on the king and be in his service. Let her lie in your arms, that my lord the king may be warm."
- 3 *So they sought for a fair damsel throughout all the coasts of Israel, and found Abishag a Shunammite, and brought her to the king.* So they sought for a beautiful young woman throughout all the territory of Israel, and found Abishag the Shunammite, and brought her to the king.
- 4 *And the damsel was very fair, and cherished the king, and ministered to him: but the king knew her not.* The young woman was very beautiful. She was of service to the king and attended to him, but the king had no relations with her.
- 5 *Then Adonijah the son of Haggith exalted himself, saying, I will be king: and he prepared him chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him.* Now Adonijah the son of Haggith exalted himself, saying, "I will be king." And he prepared for himself chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him.
- 6 *And his father had not displeased him at any time in saying, Why hast thou done so? and he also was a very goodly man; and his mother bare him after Absalom.* His father had never at any time displeased him by asking, "Why have you done thus and so?" He was also a very handsome man. He was born next after Absalom.
- 7 *And he conferred with Joab the son of Zeruiah, and with Abiathar the priest: and they following Adonijah helped him.* He conferred with Joab the son of Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest. And they followed Adonijah and helped him.

- 8 *But Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and Nathan the prophet, and Shimei, and Rei, and the mighty men which belonged to David, were not with Adonijah.* But Zadok the priest and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada and Nathan the prophet and Shimei and Rei and David's mighty men were not with Adonijah.
- 9 *And Adonijah slew sheep and oxen and fat cattle by the stone of Zohelath, which is by Enrogel, and called all his brethren the king's sons, and all the men of Judah the king's servants:* Adonijah sacrificed sheep, oxen, and fattened cattle by the Serpent's Stone, which is beside En-rogel. He invited all his brothers, the king's sons. All the royal officials of Judah,
- 10 *But Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah, and the mighty men, and Solomon his brother, he called not.* But he did not invite Nathan the prophet or Benaiah or the mighty men or Solomon his brother.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Solomon** (SOL-oh-mon) — "peace" — David and Bathsheba's son, Israel's third king. The wisest man who ever lived, builder of the first temple in Jerusalem, author of Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and Song of Solomon. His foreign wives led him into idolatry in old age, and God tore the kingdom from his son.

- 11 *Wherefore Nathan spake unto Bathsheba the mother of Solomon, saying, Hast thou not heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith doth reign, and David our lord knoweth it not?* Then Nathan said to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon, "Have you not heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith has become king and David our lord does not know it?"
- 12 *Now therefore come, let me, I pray thee, give thee counsel, that thou mayest save thine own life, and the life of thy son Solomon.* Now therefore come, let me give you advice, that you may save your own life and the life of your son Solomon.
- 13 *Go and get thee in unto king David, and say unto him, Didst not thou, my lord, O king, swear unto thine handmaid, saying, Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne? why then doth Adonijah reign?* Go in at once to King David and say to him, "Did you not, my lord the king, swear to your servant, saying, "Solomon your son shall reign after me. He shall sit on my throne"? Why then is Adonijah king?"

- 14 *Behold, while thou yet talkest there with the king, I also will come in after thee, and confirm thy words.* While you are still talking there with the king, I also will come in after you and confirm your words."
- 15 *And Bathsheba went in unto the king into the chamber: and the king was very old; and Abishag the Shunammite ministered unto the king.* So Bathsheba went to the king in his chamber (now the king was very old, and Abishag the Shunammite was attending to the king).
- 16 *And Bathsheba bowed, and did obeisance unto the king. And the king said, What wouldest thou?* Bathsheba bowed and paid homage to the king, and the king said, "What do you desire?"
- 17 *And she said unto him, My lord, thou swarest by the LORD thy God unto thine handmaid, saying, Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne.* She said to Him, "My lord, You swore to Your servant by the LORD Your God, saying, 'Solomon your son shall reign after me. He shall sit on my throne.'
- 18 *And now, behold, Adonijah reigneth; and now, my lord the king, thou knowest it not:* Now, see, Adonijah is king, although you, my lord the king, do not know it.
- 19 *And he hath slain oxen and fat cattle and sheep in abundance, and hath called all the sons of the king, and Abiathar the priest, and Joab the captain of the host: but Solomon thy servant hath he not called.* He has sacrificed oxen, fattened cattle, and sheep in abundance, and has invited all the sons of the king, Abiathar the priest, and Joab the commander of the army, but Solomon your servant he has not invited.
- 20 *And thou, my lord, O king, the eyes of all Israel are upon thee, that thou shouldest tell them who shall sit on the throne of my lord the king after him.* Now, my lord the king, the eyes of all Israel are on you, to tell them who shall sit on the throne of my lord the king after him.
- 21 *Otherwise it shall come to pass, when my lord the king shall sleep with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon shall be counted offenders.* Otherwise it will come to pass, when my lord the king sleeps with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon will be counted offenders."

- 22 *And, lo, while she yet talked with the king, Nathan the prophet also came in.* While she was still speaking with the king, Nathan the prophet came in.
- 23 *And they told the king, saying, Behold Nathan the prophet. And when he was come in before the king, he bowed himself before the king with his face to the ground.* They told the king, "Here is Nathan the prophet." And when he came in before the king, he bowed before the king with his face to the ground.
- 24 *And Nathan said, My lord, O king, hast thou said, Adonijah shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne?* Nathan said, "My lord the king, have you said, 'Adonijah shall reign after me. He shall sit on my throne'?"
- 25 *For he is gone down this day, and hath slain oxen and fat cattle and sheep in abundance, and hath called all the king's sons, and the captains of the host, and Abiathar the priest; and, behold, they eat and drink before him, and say, God save king Adonijah.* For he has gone down this day and has sacrificed oxen, fattened cattle, and sheep in abundance, and has invited all the king's sons, the commanders of the army, and Abiathar the priest. And look, they are eating and drinking before him, and saying, 'Long live King Adonijah!'
- 26 *But me, even me thy servant, and Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and thy servant Solomon, hath he not called.* But me, your servant, and Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and your servant Solomon he has not invited.
- 27 *Is this thing done by my lord the king, and thou hast not shewed it unto thy servant, who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?* Has this thing been brought about by my lord the king and you have not told your servants who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?"
- 28 *Then king David answered and said, Call me Bathsheba. And she came into the king's presence, and stood before the king.* Then King David answered, "Call Bathsheba to me." So she came into the king's presence and stood before the king.
- 29 *And the king sware, and said, As the LORD liveth, that hath redeemed my soul out of all distress,* The king swore, saying, "As the LORD lives, who has redeemed my soul out of every adversity,

- 30 *Even as I swear unto thee by the LORD God of Israel, saying, Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne in my stead; even so will I certainly do this day.* As I swore to You by the LORD, the God of Israel, saying, 'Solomon your son shall reign after me. He shall sit on my throne in my place,' even so will I do this day."
- 31 *Then Bathsheba bowed with her face to the earth, and did reverence to the king, and said, Let my lord king David live for ever.* Then Bathsheba bowed with her face to the ground and paid homage to the king and said, "May my lord King David live forever!"
- 32 *And king David said, Call me Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada. And they came before the king.* King David said, "Call to me Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada." So they came before the king.
- 33 *The king also said unto them, Take with you the servants of your lord, and cause Solomon my son to ride upon mine own mule, and bring him down to Gihon:* The king said to them, "Take with you the servants of your lord and have Solomon my son ride on my own mule, and bring him down to Gihon.
- 34 *And let Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him there king over Israel: and blow ye with the trumpet, and say, God save king Solomon.* Let Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet there anoint him king over Israel. Then blow the trumpet and say, 'Long live King Solomon!'
- 35 *Then ye shall come up after him, that he may come and sit upon my throne; for he shall be king in my stead: and I have appointed him to be ruler over Israel and over Judah.* You shall then come up after him. He shall come and sit on my throne, for he shall be king in my place. And I have appointed him to be ruler over Israel and over Judah."
- 36 *And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered the king, and said, Amen: the LORD God of my lord the king say so too.* Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered the king, "Amen! May the LORD, the God of my lord the king, say so.

- 37 *As the LORD hath been with my lord the king, even so be he with Solomon, and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord king David.* As the LORD has been with my lord the king, even so may he be with Solomon, and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord King David."
- 38 *So Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, went down, and caused Solomon to ride upon king David's mule, and brought him to Gihon.* So Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites went down and had Solomon ride on King David's mule and brought him to Gihon.
- 39 *And Zadok the priest took an horn of oil out of the tabernacle, and anointed Solomon. And they blew the trumpet; and all the people said, God save king Solomon.* There Zadok the priest took the horn of oil from the tabernacle and anointed Solomon. Then they blew the trumpet. All the people said, "Long live King Solomon!"
- 40 *And all the people came up after him, and the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth rent with the sound of them.* All the people went up after him, playing on pipes and rejoicing with great joy, so that the earth was split by their noise.
- 41 *And Adonijah and all the guests that were with him heard it as they had made an end of eating. And when Joab heard the sound of the trumpet, he said, Wherefore is this noise of the city being in an uproar?* Adonijah and all the guests who were with him heard it as they finished eating. And when Joab heard the sound of the trumpet, he said, "What does this uproar in the city mean?"
- 42 *And while he yet spake, behold, Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest came; and Adonijah said unto him, Come in; for thou art a valiant man, and bringest good tidings.* While he was still speaking, Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest came. And Adonijah said, "Come in, for you are a worthy man and bring good news."
- 43 *And Jonathan answered and said to Adonijah, Verily our lord king David hath made Solomon king.* Jonathan answered Adonijah, "No, for our lord King David has made Solomon king,

- 44 *And the king hath sent with him Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, and they have caused him to ride upon the king's mule:* The king has sent with him Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites. And they had him ride on the king's mule.
- 45 *And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king in Gihon: and they are come up from thence rejoicing, so that the city rang again. This is the noise that ye have heard.* Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king at Gihon. They have gone up from there rejoicing, so that the city is in an uproar. That is the noise that you have heard.
- 46 *And also Solomon sitteth on the throne of the kingdom.* Solomon sits on the royal throne.
- 47 *And moreover the king's servants came to bless our lord king David, saying, God make the name of Solomon better than thy name, and make his throne greater than thy throne. And the king bowed himself upon the bed.* Moreover, the king's servants came to congratulate our lord King David, saying, 'May your God make the name of Solomon more famous than yours, and make his throne greater than your throne.' And the king bowed himself on the bed.
- 48 *And also thus said the king, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which hath given one to sit on my throne this day, mine eyes even seeing it.* The king also said, 'Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who has granted someone to sit on my throne this day, my own eyes seeing it.' "
- 49 *And all the guests that were with Adonijah were afraid, and rose up, and went every man his way.* Then all the guests of Adonijah trembled and rose, and each went his own way.
- 50 *And Adonijah feared because of Solomon, and arose, and went, and caught hold on the horns of the altar.* Adonijah feared Solomon. So he arose and went and took hold of the horns of the altar.

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| <p>51 <i>And it was told Solomon, saying, Behold, Adonijah feareth king Solomon: for, lo, he hath caught hold on the horns of the altar, saying, Let king Solomon swear unto me to day that he will not slay his servant with the sword.</i></p> <p>52 <i>And Solomon said, If he will shew himself a worthy man, there shall not an hair of him fall to the earth: but if wickedness shall be found in him, he shall die.</i></p> <p>53 <i>So king Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the altar. And he came and bowed himself to king Solomon: and Solomon said unto him, Go to thine house.</i></p> | <p>Then it was told Solomon, " Adonijah fears King Solomon, for he has taken hold of the horns of the altar, saying, 'Let King Solomon swear to me first that he will not put his servant to death with the sword.' "</p> <p>Solomon said, "If he proves to be a worthy man, not one of his hairs shall fall to the earth, but if wickedness is found in him, he shall die."</p> <p>So King Solomon sent. They brought him down from the altar. And he came and paid homage to King Solomon, and Solomon said to him, "Go to your house."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Bathsheba (*bath-SHEE-bah*) — The wife of Uriah whom David took in adultery — after Uriah's death she married David; mother of Solomon; her name means 'daughter of the oath.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

v1 — Josh 23:1-2; 1 Chr 29:27-28; 1 Chr 23:1; Ps 90:10; 2 Sam 5:4

v2 — Eccl 4:11; Gen 16:5; Mic 7:5; 1 Sam 16:21-22; Deut 10:8

v3 — Josh 19:18; Esth 2:4; Esth 2:2

v5 — 2 Sam 15:1; 2 Sam 3:4
v6 — 2 Sam 3:3-4; 1 Sam 3:13
v13 — 1 Kgs 1:30; 1 Kgs 1:17
v21 — 1 Kgs 2:10; Deut 31:16
v30 — 1 Kgs 1:13; 1 Kgs 1:17
v34 — 1 Sam 10:1; 2 Sam 15:10; 1 Kgs 1:25
v37 — 1 Kgs 1:47; 1 Sam 20:13
v39 — Ps 89:20; 1 Sam 10:24; 1 Chr 29:22; 1 Kgs 1:34
v52 — 1 Sam 14:45; 2 Sam 14:11

Chapter 2

David charged Solomon to walk in the LORD's ways and gave instructions regarding Joab, Shimei, and others before dying after a forty-year reign. Solomon consolidated his rule by executing Adonijah, Joab, and Shimei, and removing Abiathar from the priesthood.

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| <p>1 <i>Now the days of David drew nigh that he should die; and he charged Solomon his son, saying,</i></p> | <p>When David's time to die drew near, he commanded Solomon his son, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>I go the way of all the earth: be thou strong therefore, and shew thyself a man;</i></p> | <p>"I am about to go the way of all the earth. Be strong, and show yourself a man,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And keep the charge of the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, to keep his statutes, and his commandments, and his judgments, and his testimonies, as it is written in the law of Moses, that thou mayest prosper in all that thou doest, and whithersoever thou turnest thyself:</i></p> | <p>Keep the charge of the LORD Your God, walking in His ways and keeping His statutes, His commandments, His rules. His testimonies, as it is written in the Law of Moses, that you may prosper in all that you do and wherever You turn,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>That the LORD may continue his word which he spake concerning me, saying, If thy children take heed to their way, to walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, there shall not fail thee (said he) a man on the throne of Israel.</i></p> | <p>That the LORD may establish His word that He spoke concerning me, saying, 'If Your sons pay close attention to their way, to walk before me in faithfulness with all their heart and with all their soul, You shall not lack a man on the throne of Israel.'</p> |

- 5 *Moreover thou knowest also what Joab the son of Zeruiah did to me, and what he did to the two captains of the hosts of Israel, unto Abner the son of Ner, and unto Amasa the son of Jether, whom he slew, and shed the blood of war in peace, and put the blood of war upon his girdle that was about his loins, and in his shoes that were on his feet.* Moreover, You also know what Joab the son of Zeruiah did to me, how he dealt with the two commanders of the armies of Israel, Abner the son of Ner, and Amasa the son of Jether, whom He killed, putting in time of peace blood that had been shed in war, and putting the blood of war on the belt around His waist and on the sandals on His feet.
- 6 *Do therefore according to thy wisdom, and let not his hoar head go down to the grave in peace.* Act therefore according to Your wisdom, but do not let His gray head go down to the grave in peace.
- 7 *But shew kindness unto the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite, and let them be of those that eat at thy table: for so they came to me when I fled because of Absalom thy brother.* But deal loyally with the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite, and let them be among those who eat at your table, for with such loyalty they met me when I fled from Absalom your brother.
- 8 *And, behold, thou hast with thee Shimei the son of Gera, a Benjamite of Bahurim, which cursed me with a grievous curse in the day when I went to Mahanaim: but he came down to meet me at Jordan, and I sware to him by the LORD, saying, I will not put thee to death with the sword.* There is also with You Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjaminite from Bahurim, who cursed me with a grievous curse on the day when I went to Mahanaim. But when He came down to meet me at the Jordan, I swore to Him by the LORD, saying, 'I will not put You to death with the sword.'
- 9 *Now therefore hold him not guiltless: for thou art a wise man, and knowest what thou oughtest to do unto him; but his hoar head bring thou down to the grave with blood.* Now therefore do not hold Him guiltless, for You are a wise man. You will know what You ought to do to Him, and You shall bring His gray head down with blood to the grave."
- 10 *So David slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David.* Then David slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David.

- 11 *And the days that David reigned over Israel were forty years: seven years reigned he in Hebron, and thirty and three years reigned he in Jerusalem.* The time that David reigned over Israel was forty years. He reigned seven years in Hebron and thirty-three years in Jerusalem.
- 12 *Then sat Solomon upon the throne of David his father; and his kingdom was established greatly.* So Solomon sat on the throne of David his father. His kingdom was firmly established.
- 13 *And Adonijah the son of Haggith came to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon. And she said, Comest thou peaceably? And he said, Peaceably.* Then Adonijah the son of Haggith came to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon. She said, "Do you come peaceably?" He said, "Peaceably."
- 14 *He said moreover, I have somewhat to say unto thee. And she said, Say on.* Then he said, "I have something to say to you." She said, "Speak."
- 15 *And he said, Thou knowest that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should reign: howbeit the kingdom is turned about, and is become my brother's: for it was his from the LORD.* He said, "You know that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel fully expected me to reign. However, the kingdom has turned about and become my brother's, for it was His from the LORD.
- 16 *And now I ask one petition of thee, deny me not. And she said unto him, Say on.* Now I have one request to make of You; do not refuse me." She said to Him, "Speak."
- 17 *And he said, Speak, I pray thee, unto Solomon the king, (for he will not say thee nay,) that he give me Abishag the Shunammite to wife.* He said, "Please ask King Solomon—he will not refuse you—to give me Abishag the Shunammite as my wife."
- 18 *And Bathsheba said, Well; I will speak for thee unto the king.* Bathsheba said, "Very well; I will speak for you to the king."

- 19 *Bathsheba therefore went unto king Solomon, to speak unto him for Adonijah. And the king rose up to meet her, and bowed himself unto her, and sat down on his throne, and caused a seat to be set for the king's mother; and she sat on his right hand.* So Bathsheba went to King Solomon to speak to him on behalf of Adonijah. And the king rose to meet her and bowed down to her. Then he sat on his throne and had a seat brought for the king's mother. She sat on his right hand.
- 20 *Then she said, I desire one small petition of thee; I pray thee, say me not nay. And the king said unto her, Ask on, my mother: for I will not say thee nay.* Then she said, "I have one small request to make of you; do not refuse me." And the king said to her, "Make your request, my mother, for I will not refuse you."
- 21 *And she said, Let Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah thy brother to wife.* She said, "Let Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah your brother as his wife."
- 22 *And king Solomon answered and said unto his mother, And why dost thou ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? ask for him the kingdom also; for he is mine elder brother; even for him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for Joab the son of Zeruiah.* King Solomon answered his mother, "And why do you ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? Ask for him the kingdom also, for he is my older brother, and on his side are Abiathar the priest and Joab the son of Zeruiah."
- 23 *Then king Solomon sware by the LORD, saying, God do so to me, and more also, if Adonijah have not spoken this word against his own life.* Then King Solomon swore by the LORD, saying, "God do so to me and more also if this word does not cost Adonijah his life!
- 24 *Now therefore, as the LORD liveth, which hath established me, and set me on the throne of David my father, and who hath made me an house, as he promised, Adonijah shall be put to death this day.* Now therefore as the LORD lives, who has established me and placed me on the throne of David my father, and who has made me a house, as he promised, Adonijah shall be put to death today."

- 25 *And king Solomon sent by the hand of Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; and he fell upon him that he died.* So King Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada. He struck him down. He died.
- 26 *And unto Abiathar the priest said the king, Get thee to Anathoth, unto thine own fields; for thou art worthy of death: but I will not at this time put thee to death, because thou barest the ark of the Lord GOD before David my father, and because thou hast been afflicted in all wherein my father was afflicted.* To Abiathar the priest the king said, "Go to Anathoth, to your estate, for You deserve death. But I will not at this time put You to death, because You carried the ark of the Lord GOD before David my father, and because you shared in all my father's affliction."
- 27 *So Solomon thrust out Abiathar from being priest unto the LORD; that he might fulfil the word of the LORD, which he spake concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh.* So Solomon expelled Abiathar from being priest to the LORD, thus fulfilling the word of the LORD that He had spoken concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh.
- 28 *Then tidings came to Joab: for Joab had turned after Adonijah, though he turned not after Absalom. And Joab fled unto the tabernacle of the LORD, and caught hold on the horns of the altar.* When the news came to Joab—for Joab had supported Adonijah although he had not supported Absalom—Joab fled to the tabernacle of the LORD and caught hold of the horns of the altar.
- 29 *And it was told king Solomon that Joab was fled unto the tabernacle of the LORD; and, behold, he is by the altar. Then Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, saying, Go, fall upon him.* When it was told King Solomon, "Joab has fled to the tabernacle of the LORD. He is beside the altar," Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, saying, "Go, strike him down."

- 30 *And Benaiah came to the tabernacle of the LORD, and said unto him, Thus saith the king, Come forth. And he said, Nay; but I will die here. And Benaiah brought the king word again, saying, Thus said Joab, and thus he answered me.* So Benaiah came to the tabernacle of the LORD and said to Him, "The king commands, 'Come out.' " But he said, "No, I will die here." Then Benaiah brought the king word again, saying, "Thus said Joab, and thus he answered me."
- 31 *And the king said unto him, Do as he hath said, and fall upon him, and bury him; that thou mayest take away the innocent blood, which Joab shed, from me, and from the house of my father.* The king replied to him, "Do as he has said, strike him down and bury him, and thus take away from me and from my father's house the guilt for the blood that Joab shed without cause."
- 32 *And the LORD shall return his blood upon his own head, who fell upon two men more righteous and better than he, and slew them with the sword, my father David not knowing thereof, to wit, Abner the son of Ner, captain of the host of Israel, and Amasa the son of Jether, captain of the host of Judah.* The LORD will bring back His bloody deeds on His own head, because, without the knowledge of my father David, he attacked and killed with the sword two men more righteous and better than Himself, Abner the son of Ner, commander of the army of Israel, and Amasa the son of Jether, commander of the army of Judah.
- 33 *Their blood shall therefore return upon the head of Joab, and upon the head of his seed for ever: but upon David, and upon his seed, and upon his house, and upon his throne, shall there be peace for ever from the LORD.* So shall their blood come back on the head of Joab and on the head of his descendants forever. But for David and for his descendants and for his house and for His throne there shall be peace from the LORD forevermore."
- 34 *So Benaiah the son of Jehoiada went up, and fell upon him, and slew him: and he was buried in his own house in the wilderness.* Then Benaiah the son of Jehoiada went up and struck him down and put Him to death. And He was buried in His own house in the wilderness.

- 35 *And the king put Benaiah the son of Jehoiada in his room over the host: and Zadok the priest did the king put in the room of Abiathar.* The king put Benaiah the son of Jehoiada over the army in place of Joab, and the king put Zadok the priest in the place of Abiathar.
- 36 *And the king sent and called for Shimei, and said unto him, Build thee an house in Jerusalem, and dwell there, and go not forth thence any whither.* Then the king sent and summoned Shimei and said to him, "Build yourself a house in Jerusalem and dwell there, and do not go out from there to any place whatever.
- 37 *For it shall be, that on the day thou goest out, and passest over the brook Kidron, thou shalt know for certain that thou shalt surely die: thy blood shall be upon thine own head.* For on the day you go out and cross the brook Kidron, know for certain that you shall die. Your blood shall be on your own head."
- 38 *And Shimei said unto the king, The saying is good: as my lord the king hath said, so will thy servant do. And Shimei dwelt in Jerusalem many days.* Shimei said to the king, "What you say is good; as my lord the king has said, so will your servant do." So Shimei lived in Jerusalem many days.
- 39 *And it came to pass at the end of three years, that two of the servants of Shimei ran away unto Achish son of Maachah king of Gath. And they told Shimei, saying, Behold, thy servants be in Gath.* But at the end of three years two of Shimei's servants ran away to Achish, son of Maacah, king of Gath. And when it was told Shimei, "See, your servants are in Gath,"
- 40 *And Shimei arose, and saddled his ass, and went to Gath to Achish to seek his servants: and Shimei went, and brought his servants from Gath.* Shimei arose and saddled a donkey and went to Gath to Achish to seek his servants. He went and brought his servants back from Gath.
- 41 *And it was told Solomon that Shimei had gone from Jerusalem to Gath, and was come again.* When Solomon was told that Shimei had gone from Jerusalem to Gath and returned,

- 42 *And the king sent and called for Shimei, and said unto him, Did I not make thee to swear by the LORD, and protested unto thee, saying, Know for a certain, on the day thou goest out, and walkest abroad any whither, that thou shalt surely die? and thou saidst unto me, The word that I have heard is good.* The king sent and summoned Shimei and said to him, "Did I not make you swear by the LORD and solemnly warn You, saying, 'Know for certain that on the day You go out and go to any place whatever, You shall surely die'? And You said to me, 'What You say is good; I will obey.'"
- 43 *Why then hast thou not kept the oath of the LORD, and the commandment that I have charged thee with?* Why then have You not kept Your oath to the LORD and the commandment with which I charged You?"
- 44 *The king said moreover to Shimei, Thou knowest all the wickedness which thine heart is privy to, that thou didst to David my father: therefore the LORD shall return thy wickedness upon thine own head;* The king also said to Shimei, "You know in your own heart all the harm that you did to David my father. So the LORD will bring back your harm on Your own head."
- 45 *And king Solomon shall be blessed, and the throne of David shall be established before the LORD for ever.* But King Solomon shall be blessed, and the throne of David shall be established before the LORD forever."
- 46 *So the king commanded Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; which went out, and fell upon him, that he died. And the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon.* Then the king commanded Benaiah the son of Jehoiada. He went out and struck him down. He died. So the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon.

Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Eli (EE-ly) — The high priest who raised Samuel — his sons Hophni and Phinehas were corrupt; he died when he heard the ark was captured; his name means 'my God.'

Hebron (HEE-bron) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Jordan (JOR-dan) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Josh 1:6-7; Eph 6:10; Josh 23:14; 1 Cor 16:13; Heb 9:27
- v3 — Deut 29:9; Prov 3:1-4; Ps 119:2; Deut 17:18-20; 1 Chr 22:12-13
- v4 — 2 Kgs 20:3; 2 Sam 7:25; 1 Kgs 8:25
- v5 — 2 Sam 3:27; 2 Sam 20:10
- v7 — 2 Sam 17:27-29; 2 Sam 9:7; 2 Sam 19:31-40; 2 Sam 9:10
- v10 — Acts 2:29; Acts 13:36; 1 Chr 29:28; 1 Kgs 1:21; 1 Kgs 11:43
- v15 — 1 Chr 22:9-10; 1 Chr 28:5-7
- v27 — 1 Sam 2:27-36; 1 Sam 3:12-14
- v28 — 1 Kgs 1:7; 1 Kgs 1:50
- v31 — Deut 21:8-9; Num 35:33; Ex 21:14
- v37 — 2 Sam 1:16; 2 Sam 15:23
- v46 — 1 Kgs 2:12; 2 Chr 1:1

Chapter 3

The LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream at Gibeon and offered him whatever he wished; Solomon asked for wisdom. God gave him unmatched wisdom and also riches and honor; Solomon demonstrated his wisdom by discerning the true mother of a disputed child.

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| <p>1 <i>And Solomon made affinity with Pharaoh king of Egypt, and took Pharaoh's daughter, and brought her into the city of David, until he had made an end of building his own house, and the house of the LORD, and the wall of Jerusalem round about.</i></p> | <p>Solomon made a marriage alliance with Pharaoh king of Egypt. He took Pharaoh's daughter and brought her into the city of David until he had finished building his own house and the house of the LORD and the wall around Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Only the people sacrificed in high places, because there was no house built unto the name of the LORD, until those days.</i></p> | <p>The people were sacrificing at the high places, however, because no house had yet been built for the name of the LORD.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Solomon loved the LORD, walking in the statutes of David his father: only he sacrificed and burnt incense in high places.</i></p> | <p>Solomon loved the LORD, walking in the statutes of David his father, only he sacrificed and made offerings at the high places.</p> |

- 4 *And the king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there; for that was the great high place: a thousand burnt offerings did Solomon offer upon that altar.* The king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there, for that was the great high place. Solomon used to offer a thousand burnt offerings on that altar.
- 5 *In Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, Ask what I shall give thee.* At Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night. God said, "Ask what I shall give You."
- 6 *And Solomon said, Thou hast shewed unto thy servant David my father great mercy, according as he walked before thee in truth, and in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart with thee; and thou hast kept for him this great kindness, that thou hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day.* Solomon said, "You have shown great mercy to your servant David my father, because he walked before you in faithfulness, in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart toward you. And you have kept for him this great mercy and have given him a son to sit on his throne this day.
- 7 *And now, O LORD my God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David my father: and I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in.* Now, O LORD my God, You have made Your servant king in place of David my father, although I am but a little child. I do not know how to go out or come in.
- 8 *And thy servant is in the midst of thy people which thou hast chosen, a great people, that cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude.* Your servant is in the midst of Your people whom You have chosen, a great people, too many to be numbered or counted.
- 9 *Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people?* Give Your servant therefore an understanding mind to govern Your people, that I may discern between good and evil, for who is able to govern this Your great people?"
- 10 *And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.* It pleased the Lord that Solomon had asked this.

- 11 *And God said unto him, Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life; neither hast asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies; but hast asked for thyself understanding to discern judgment;* God said to Him, "Because you have asked this, and have not asked for yourself long life or riches or the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern what is right,
- 12 *Behold, I have done according to thy words: lo, I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee.* See, I now do according to your word. See, I give you a wise and discerning mind, so that none like you has been before you and none like you shall arise after you.
- 13 *And I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the kings like unto thee all thy days.* I give you also what you have not asked, both riches and honor, so that no other king shall compare with you, all your days.
- 14 *And if thou wilt walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as thy father David did walk, then I will lengthen thy days.* If you will walk in my ways, keeping my statutes and my commandments, as your father David walked, then I will lengthen your days."
- 15 *And Solomon awoke; and, behold, it was a dream. And he came to Jerusalem, and stood before the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and offered up burnt offerings, and offered peace offerings, and made a feast to all his servants.* Solomon awoke. It was a dream. Then he came to Jerusalem and stood before the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and offered up burnt offerings and peace offerings, and made a feast for all His servants.
- 16 *Then came there two women, that were harlots, unto the king, and stood before him.* Then two prostitutes came to the king and stood before him.

- 17 *And the one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house; and I was delivered of a child with her in the house.* The one woman said, "Oh, my lord, this woman and I live in the same house. I gave birth to a child while she was in the house.
- 18 *And it came to pass the third day after that I was delivered, that this woman was delivered also: and we were together; there was no stranger with us in the house, save we two in the house.* Then on the third day after I gave birth, this woman also gave birth. And we were alone. There was no one else with us in the house; only we two were in the house.
- 19 *And this woman's child died in the night; because she overlaid it.* This woman's son died in the night, because she lay on him.
- 20 *And she arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me, while thine handmaid slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom.* She arose at midnight and took my son from beside me, while your servant slept, and laid him at her breast, and laid her dead son at my breast.
- 21 *And when I rose in the morning to give my child suck, behold, it was dead: but when I had considered it in the morning, behold, it was not my son, which I did bear.* When I rose in the morning to nurse my child, he was dead. But when I looked at him closely in the morning, he was not the child that I had borne."
- 22 *And the other woman said, Nay; but the living is my son, and the dead is thy son. And this said, No; but the dead is thy son, and the living is my son. Thus they spake before the king.* But the other woman said, "No, the living child is mine, and the dead child is yours." The first said, "No, the dead child is yours, and the living child is mine." Thus they spoke before the king.
- 23 *Then said the king, The one saith, This is my son that liveth, and thy son is the dead: and the other saith, Nay; but thy son is the dead, and my son is the living.* Then the king said, "The one says, 'This is my son that is alive, and your son is dead,' and the other says, 'No; but your son is dead, and my son is the living one.' "

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| <p>24 <i>And the king said, Bring me a sword. And they brought a sword before the king.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And the king said, Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Then spake the woman whose the living child was unto the king, for her bowels yearned upon her son, and she said, O my lord, give her the living child, and in no wise slay it. But the other said, Let it be neither mine nor thine, but divide it.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Then the king answered and said, Give her the living child, and in no wise slay it: she is the mother thereof.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And all Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to do judgment.</i></p> | <p>The king said, "Bring me a sword." So a sword was brought before the king.</p> <p>The king said, "Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one and half to the other."</p> <p>Then the woman whose son was alive said to the king, because her heart yearned for her son, "Oh, my lord, give her the living child, and by no means put him to death." But the other said, "He shall be neither mine nor yours; divide him."</p> <p>Then the king answered and said, "Give the living child to the first woman, and by no means put him to death; she is his mother."</p> <p>All Israel heard of the judgment that the king had rendered. They stood in awe of the king, because they saw that the wisdom of God was in Him to do justice.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

- v3** — 1 Cor 8:3; Ps 31:23; Deut 6:5; Deut 30:16
v4 — 2 Chr 7:5; 1 Chr 16:39; 2 Chr 1:3; 1 Chr 21:29; 2 Chr 1:6-12
v5 — Jas 1:5-6; 1 Kgs 9:2; 2 Chr 1:7-12; Num 12:6; John 14:13-14
v6 — 1 Kgs 9:4; 1 Kgs 1:48; 1 Kgs 2:4; 2 Cor 9:11
v7 — Num 27:17; 1 Chr 29:1; Jer 1:6
v9 — Jas 1:5; Heb 5:14; Prov 16:16; John 5:30; Prov 2:3-9
v11 — Jas 4:2-3; Rom 8:26; Prov 16:31; 1 Kgs 3:9
v12 — 1 John 5:14-15; Eccl 1:16; Matt 12:42; 1 Kgs 5:12; 1 Kgs 10:23-24
v13 — Eph 3:20; Matt 6:33; Prov 3:16; Rom 8:32; 1 Kgs 4:21-24
v14 — Prov 3:2; Ps 91:16; Zech 3:7; 1 Kgs 15:5; 2 Chr 34:2
v26 — Isa 49:15; Jer 31:20; 1 John 3:17; Gen 43:30; Hos 11:8
v28 — 1 Kgs 3:9-12; Dan 2:47; Col 2:3; 1 Cor 1:24

Chapter 4

Solomon's officials and governors are listed, and his kingdom extended from the Euphrates to Egypt. Israel lived in safety, and Solomon's wisdom exceeded all the wisdom of the east; he spoke 3,000 proverbs and 1,005 songs.

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| 1 | <i>So king Solomon was king over all Israel.</i> | King Solomon was king over all Israel, |
| 2 | <i>And these were the princes which he had; Azariah the son of Zadok the priest,</i> | These were his high officials: Azariah the son of Zadok was the priest; |
| 3 | <i>Elihoreph and Ahiah, the sons of Shisha, scribes; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, the recorder;</i> | Elihoreph and Ahijah the sons of Shisha were secretaries; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder; |
| 4 | <i>And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the host: and Zadok and Abiathar were the priests:</i> | Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was in command of the army; Zadok and Abiathar were priests; |
| 5 | <i>And Azariah the son of Nathan was over the officers: and Zabud the son of Nathan was principal officer, and the king's friend:</i> | Azariah the son of Nathan was over the officers; Zabud the son of Nathan was principal officer and king's friend; |
| 6 | <i>And Ahishar was over the household: and Adoniram the son of Abda was over the tribute.</i> | Ahishar was in charge of the palace. Adoniram the son of Abda was in charge of the forced labor. |

- 7 *And Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, which provided victuals for the king and his household: each man his month in a year made provision.* Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, who provided food for the king and his household. Each man had to make provision for one month in the year.
- 8 *And these are their names: The son of Hur, in mount Ephraim:* These were their names: The son of Hur, in the hill country of Ephraim;
- 9 *The son of Dekar, in Makaz, and in Shaalbim, and Bethshemesh, and Elonbethhanan:* The son of Dekar, in Makaz, Shaalbim, Beth-shemesh, and Elon-beth-hanan;
- 10 *The son of Hesed, in Aruboth; to him pertained Sochoh, and all the land of Hopher:* The son of Hesed, in Arubboth (to him belonged Socoh and all the land of Hopher);
- 11 *The son of Abinadab, in all the region of Dor; which had Taphath the daughter of Solomon to wife:* The son of Abinadab, in all Naphath-dor (he had Taphath the daughter of Solomon as his wife);
- 12 *Baana the son of Ahilud; to him pertained Taanach and Megiddo, and all Bethshean, which is by Zartanah beneath Jezreel, from Bethshean to Abelmeholah, even unto the place that is beyond Jokneam:* Baana the son of Ahilud, in Taanach, Megiddo. All Beth-shean that is beside Zarethan below Jezreel, and from Beth-shean to Abel-meholah, as far as the other side of Jokneam;
- 13 *The son of Geber, in Ramothgilead; to him pertained the towns of Jair the son of Manasseh, which are in Gilead; to him also pertained the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, threescore great cities with walls and brasen bars:* The son of Geber, in Ramoth-gilead (he had the villages of Jair the son of Manasseh, which are in Gilead. He had the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, sixty great cities with walls and bronze bars);
- 14 *Ahinadab the son of Iddo had Mahanaim:* Ahinadab the son of Iddo, in Mahanaim;
- 15 *Ahimaaz was in Naphtali; he also took Basmath the daughter of Solomon to wife:* Ahimaaz, in Naphtali (he had taken Basmath the daughter of Solomon as his wife);

- 16 *Baanah the son of Hushai was in Asher and in Aloth:* Baana the son of Hushai, in Asher and Bealoth;
- 17 *Jehoshaphat the son of Paruah, in Issachar:* Jehoshaphat the son of Paruah, in Issachar;
- 18 *Shimei the son of Elah, in Benjamin:* Shimei the son of Ela, in Benjamin;
- 19 *Geber the son of Uri was in the country of Gilead, in the country of Sihon king of the Amorites, and of Og king of Bashan; and he was the only officer which was in the land.* Geber the son of Uri, in the land of Gilead, the country of Sihon king of the Amorites and of Og king of Bashan. And there was one governor who was over the land.
- 20 *Judah and Israel were many, as the sand which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking, and making merry.* Judah and Israel were as many as the sand by the sea. They ate and drank and were happy.
- 21 *And Solomon reigned over all kingdoms from the river unto the land of the Philistines, and unto the border of Egypt: they brought presents, and served Solomon all the days of his life.* Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms from the river to the land of the Philistines and to the border of Egypt. They brought tribute and served Solomon all the days of his life.
- 22 *And Solomon's provision for one day was thirty measures of fine flour, and threescore measures of meal,* Solomon's provision for one day was thirty cors of fine flour and sixty cors of meal,
- 23 *Ten fat oxen, and twenty oxen out of the pastures, and an hundred sheep, beside harts, and roebucks, and fallowdeer, and fatted fowl.* Ten fat oxen, and twenty pasture-fed cattle, a hundred sheep, besides deer, gazelles, roebucks, and fattened fowl.
- 24 *For he had dominion over all the region on this side the river, from Tiphseh even to Azzah, over all the kings on this side the river: and he had peace on all sides round about him.* For he had dominion over all the region on this side the river from Tiphseh even to Azzah, over all the kings on this side the river. And he had peace on all sides around him.

- 25 *And Judah and Israel dwelt safely, every man under his vine and under his fig tree, from Dan even to Beersheba, all the days of Solomon.* Judah and Israel lived in safety, from Dan even to Beersheba, every man under his vine and under his fig tree, all the days of Solomon.
- 26 *And Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses for his chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen.* Solomon also had 4,000 stalls of horses for his chariots and 12,000 horsemen.
- 27 *And those officers provided victual for king Solomon, and for all that came unto king Solomon's table, every man in his month: they lacked nothing.* Those officers supplied provisions for King Solomon, and for all who came to King Solomon's table, each one in his month. They let nothing be lacking.
- 28 *Barley also and straw for the horses and dromedaries brought they unto the place where the officers were, every man according to his charge.* Barley also and straw for the horses and swift steeds they brought to the place where it was required, each according to his duty.
- 29 *And God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart, even as the sand that is on the sea shore.* God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding beyond measure, and breadth of mind like the sand on the seashore,
- 30 *And Solomon's wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east country, and all the wisdom of Egypt.* So that Solomon's wisdom surpassed the wisdom of all the people of the east and all the wisdom of Egypt.
- 31 *For he was wiser than all men; than Ethan the Ezrahite, and Heman, and Chalcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol: and his fame was in all nations round about.* For he was wiser than all other men, wiser than Ethan the Ezrahite, and Heman, Calcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol. His fame was in all the surrounding nations.
- 32 *And he spake three thousand proverbs: and his songs were a thousand and five.* He also spoke 3,000 proverbs. His songs were 1,005.

- 33 *And he spake of trees, from the cedar tree that is in Lebanon even unto the hyssop that springeth out of the wall: he spake also of beasts, and of fowl, and of creeping things, and of fishes.* He spoke of trees, from the cedar that is in Lebanon to the hyssop that grows out of the wall. He spoke also of beasts, and of birds, and of reptiles, and of fish.
- 34 *And there came of all people to hear the wisdom of Solomon, from all kings of the earth, which had heard of his wisdom.* People of all nations came to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and from all the kings of the earth, who had heard of his wisdom.

Words in this chapter:

victuals (VIT-ulz) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Amorites (AM-oh-rytes) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Philistines (FIL-ih-steen) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Abel (AY-bel) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Asher (ASH-er) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Benjamin (BEN-jah-min) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

v3 — 2 Sam 8:16

v4 — 1 Kgs 2:35

v13 — Deut 3:4; Num 32:41

v20 — Gen 22:17; 1 Kgs 3:8

v21 — Gen 15:18; Josh 1:4

v24 — 1 Chr 22:9; Ps 72:11

v25 — Mic 4:4; Zech 3:10

v28 — Esth 8:10; Esth 8:14

v29 — 1 Kgs 3:12; Jas 3:17; 1 Kgs 4:20; Jas 1:17; Eccl 2:26

v30 — Dan 5:11-12; Gen 25:6; Dan 1:20; Acts 7:22; Job 1:3

v31 — 1 Chr 2:6; 1 Chr 15:19; 1 Kgs 3:12

v34 — 2 Chr 9:23; 1 Kgs 10:1

Chapter 5

Solomon made an alliance with Hiram king of Tyre to supply cedar and cypress timber for the temple. Solomon conscripted laborers from Israel and sent them in shifts to Lebanon, along with stonecutters for the foundation.

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| <p>1 <i>And Hiram king of Tyre sent his servants unto Solomon; for he had heard that they had anointed him king in the room of his father: for Hiram was ever a lover of David.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And Solomon sent to Hiram, saying,</i></p> <p>3 <i>Thou knowest how that David my father could not build an house unto the name of the LORD his God for the wars which were about him on every side, until the LORD put them under the soles of his feet.</i></p> <p>4 <i>But now the LORD my God hath given me rest on every side, so that there is neither adversary nor evil occurrent.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And, behold, I purpose to build an house unto the name of the LORD my God, as the LORD spake unto David my father, saying, Thy son, whom I will set upon thy throne in thy room, he shall build an house unto my name.</i></p> | <p>Now Hiram king of Tyre sent his servants to Solomon when he heard that they had anointed him king in place of his father, for Hiram always loved David.</p> <p>Solomon sent word to Hiram,</p> <p>"You know that David my father could not build a house for the name of the LORD His God because of the warfare with which His enemies surrounded Him, until the LORD put them under the soles of His feet.</p> <p>But now the LORD my God has given me rest on every side. There is neither adversary nor misfortune.</p> <p>So I intend to build a house for the name of the LORD my God, as the LORD said to David my father, 'Your son, whom I will set on your throne in your place, shall build the house for my name.'</p> |
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- 6 *Now therefore command thou that they hew me cedar trees out of Lebanon; and my servants shall be with thy servants: and unto thee will I give hire for thy servants according to all that thou shalt appoint: for thou knowest that there is not among us any that can skill to hew timber like unto the Sidonians.* Now therefore command that cedars of Lebanon be cut for me. And my servants will join Your servants. I will pay You for Your servants whatever wages You set, for You know that there is no one among us who knows how to cut timber like the Sidonians."
- 7 *And it came to pass, when Hiram heard the words of Solomon, that he rejoiced greatly, and said, Blessed be the LORD this day, which hath given unto David a wise son over this great people.* As soon as Hiram heard the words of Solomon, he rejoiced greatly and said, "Blessed be the LORD this day, who has given to David a wise son to be over this great people."
- 8 *And Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, I have considered the things which thou sentest to me for: and I will do all thy desire concerning timber of cedar, and concerning timber of fir.* Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, "I have heard the message you sent to me. I am ready to do all you desire in the matter of cedar and cypress timber.
- 9 *My servants shall bring them down from Lebanon unto the sea: and I will convey them by sea in floats unto the place that thou shalt appoint me, and will cause them to be discharged there, and thou shalt receive them: and thou shalt accomplish my desire, in giving food for my household.* My servants shall bring it down to the sea from Lebanon. I will make it into rafts to go by sea to the place you direct. And I will have them broken up there, and you shall receive it. And you shall meet my wishes by providing food for my household."
- 10 *So Hiram gave Solomon cedar trees and fir trees according to all his desire.* So Hiram supplied Solomon with all the timber of cedar and cypress that he desired,

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| 11 | <i>And Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand measures of wheat for food to his household, and twenty measures of pure oil: thus gave Solomon to Hiram year by year.</i> | While Solomon gave Hiram 20,000 cors of wheat as food for his household, and 20,000 cors of beaten oil. Solomon gave this to Hiram year by year. |
| 12 | <i>And the LORD gave Solomon wisdom, as he promised him: and there was peace between Hiram and Solomon; and they two made a league together.</i> | The LORD gave Solomon wisdom, as he promised him. And there was peace between Hiram and Solomon, and the two of them made a treaty. |
| 13 | <i>And king Solomon raised a levy out of all Israel; and the levy was thirty thousand men.</i> | King Solomon drafted forced labor out of all Israel, and the draft numbered 30,000 men. |
| 14 | <i>And he sent them to Lebanon, ten thousand a month by courses: a month they were in Lebanon, and two months at home: and Adoniram was over the levy.</i> | He sent them to Lebanon, 10,000 a month in shifts. They would be a month in Lebanon and two months at home. Adoniram was in charge of the forced labor. |
| 15 | <i>And Solomon had threescore and ten thousand that bare burdens, and fourscore thousand hewers in the mountains;</i> | Solomon also had 70,000 burden-bearers and 80,000 stonecutters in the hill country, |
| 16 | <i>Beside the chief of Solomon's officers which were over the work, three thousand and three hundred, which ruled over the people that wrought in the work.</i> | Besides Solomon's 3,300 chief officers who were over the work, who had charge of the people who carried on the work. |
| 17 | <i>And the king commanded, and they brought great stones, costly stones, and hewed stones, to lay the foundation of the house.</i> | At the king's command they quarried out great, costly stones in order to lay the foundation of the house with dressed stones. |
| 18 | <i>And Solomon's builders and Hiram's builders did hew them, and the stonesquarers: so they prepared timber and stones to build the house.</i> | So Solomon's builders and Hiram's builders and the men of Gebal did the cutting and prepared the timber and the stone to build the house. |

Words in this chapter:

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (*shalom*).

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 14:1; 2 Sam 5:11; 1 Kgs 5:10; 2 Chr 2:3; Ps 45:12
- v3 — 1 Chr 28:3; 1 Chr 22:8
- v4 — 1 Chr 22:9; 1 Kgs 4:24
- v5 — 1 Chr 22:10; 1 Chr 17:12; 2 Sam 7:12-13; 1 Chr 28:6
- v9 — Ezek 27:17; Ezra 3:7
- v12 — 1 Kgs 3:12
- v13 — 1 Kgs 9:15
- v16 — 1 Kgs 9:23
- v17 — 1 Kgs 6:7; 1 Chr 22:2
- v18 — Josh 13:5

Chapter 6

Solomon began building the temple in the fourth year of his reign, 480 years after the Exodus. The LORD promised to dwell among Israel if Solomon obeyed His statutes; the temple was completed in seven years, overlaid inside with gold.

- 1 *And it came to pass in the four hundred and eightieth year after the children of Israel were come out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month Zif, which is the second month, that he began to build the house of the LORD.* In the four hundred and eightieth year after the people of Israel came out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month of Ziv, which is the second month, He began to build the house of the LORD.
- 2 *And the house which king Solomon built for the LORD, the length thereof was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof twenty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits.* The house that King Solomon built for the LORD was sixty cubits long, twenty cubits wide, and thirty cubits high.
- 3 *And the porch before the temple of the house, twenty cubits was the length thereof, according to the breadth of the house; and ten cubits was the breadth thereof before the house.* The vestibule in front of the nave of the house was twenty cubits long, equal to the width of the house, and ten cubits deep in front of the house.

- 4 *And for the house he made windows of narrow lights.* He made for the house windows with recessed frames.
- 5 *And against the wall of the house he built chambers round about, against the walls of the house round about, both of the temple and of the oracle: and he made chambers round about:* He also built a structure against the wall of the house, running around the walls of the house, both the nave and the inner sanctuary. And He made side chambers all around.
- 6 *The nethermost chamber was five cubits broad, and the middle was six cubits broad, and the third was seven cubits broad: for without in the wall of the house he made narrowed rests round about, that the beams should not be fastened into the walls of the house.* The lowest story was five cubits wide, the middle one was six cubits wide, and the third was seven cubits wide. For around the outside of the house He made offsets on the wall in order that the supporting beams should not be inserted into the walls of the house.
- 7 *And the house, when it was in building, was built of stone made ready before it was brought thither: so that there was neither hammer nor axe nor any tool of iron heard in the house, while it was in building.* When the house was built, it was with stone prepared at the quarry, so that neither hammer nor axe nor any tool of iron was heard in the house while it was being built.
- 8 *The door for the middle chamber was in the right side of the house: and they went up with winding stairs into the middle chamber, and out of the middle into the third.* The entrance for the lowest story was on the south side of the house, and one went up by stairs to the middle story, and from the middle story to the third.
- 9 *So he built the house, and finished it; and covered the house with beams and boards of cedar.* So He built the house and finished it. He made the ceiling of the house of beams and planks of cedar.
- 10 *And then he built chambers against all the house, five cubits high: and they rested on the house with timber of cedar.* He built the structure against the whole house, each story five cubits high. It was joined to the house with timbers of cedar.
- 11 *And the word of the LORD came to Solomon, saying,* Now the word of the LORD came to Solomon,

- 12 *Concerning this house which thou art in building, if thou wilt walk in my statutes, and execute my judgments, and keep all my commandments to walk in them; then will I perform my word with thee, which I spake unto David thy father:* "Concerning this house that you are building, if you will walk in my statutes and obey my rules and keep all my commandments and walk in them, then I will establish my word with you, which I spoke to David your father.
- 13 *And I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will not forsake my people Israel.* I will dwell among the children of Israel and will not forsake my people Israel."
- 14 *So Solomon built the house, and finished it.* So Solomon built the house and finished it.
- 15 *And he built the walls of the house within with boards of cedar, both the floor of the house, and the walls of the cieling; and he covered them on the inside with wood, and covered the floor of the house with planks of fir.* He lined the walls of the house on the inside with boards of cedar. From the floor of the house to the rafters of the ceiling, he covered them on the inside with wood. He covered the floor of the house with boards of cypress.
- 16 *And he built twenty cubits on the sides of the house, both the floor and the walls with boards of cedar: he even built them for it within, even for the oracle, even for the most holy place.* He built twenty cubits of the rear of the house with boards of cedar from the floor to the rafters. He built this within as an inner sanctuary, as the Most Holy Place.
- 17 *And the house, that is, the temple before it, was forty cubits long.* The house, that is, the nave in front of the inner sanctuary, was forty cubits long.
- 18 *And the cedar of the house within was carved with knops and open flowers: all was cedar; there was no stone seen.* The cedar within the house was carved in the form of gourds and open flowers. All was cedar; no stone was seen.
- 19 *And the oracle he prepared in the house within, to set there the ark of the covenant of the LORD.* The inner sanctuary He prepared in the innermost part of the house, to set there the ark of the covenant of the LORD.

- 20 *And the oracle in the forepart was twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits in breadth, and twenty cubits in the height thereof: and he overlaid it with pure gold; and so covered the altar which was of cedar.* The inner sanctuary was twenty cubits long, twenty cubits wide, and twenty cubits high. He overlaid it with pure gold. He also overlaid an altar of cedar.
- 21 *So Solomon overlaid the house within with pure gold: and he made a partition by the chains of gold before the oracle; and he overlaid it with gold.* Solomon overlaid the inside of the house with pure gold. He drew chains of gold across, in front of the inner sanctuary, and overlaid it with gold.
- 22 *And the whole house he overlaid with gold, until he had finished all the house: also the whole altar that was by the oracle he overlaid with gold.* He overlaid the whole house with gold, until all the house was finished. Also the whole altar that belonged to the inner sanctuary he overlaid with gold.
- 23 *And within the oracle he made two cherubims of olive tree, each ten cubits high.* In the inner sanctuary he made two cherubim of olivewood, each ten cubits high.
- 24 *And five cubits was the one wing of the cherub, and five cubits the other wing of the cherub: from the uttermost part of the one wing unto the uttermost part of the other were ten cubits.* Five cubits was the length of one wing of the cherub, and five cubits the length of the other wing of the cherub; it was ten cubits from the tip of one wing to the tip of the other.
- 25 *And the other cherub was ten cubits: both the cherubims were of one measure and one size.* The other cherub also measured ten cubits; both cherubim had the same measure and the same form.
- 26 *The height of the one cherub was ten cubits, and so was it of the other cherub.* The height of one cherub was ten cubits, and so was the other cherub.

- 27 *And he set the cherubims within the inner house: and they stretched forth the wings of the cherubims, so that the wing of the one touched the one wall, and the wing of the other cherub touched the other wall; and their wings touched one another in the midst of the house.* He put the cherubim in the innermost part of the house. And the wings of the cherubim were spread out so that a wing of one touched the one wall, and a wing of the other cherub touched the other wall; their other wings touched each other in the middle of the house.
- 28 *And he overlaid the cherubims with gold.* He overlaid the cherubim with gold.
- 29 *And he carved all the walls of the house round about with carved figures of cherubims and palm trees and open flowers, within and without.* Around all the walls of the house he carved engraved figures of cherubim and palm trees and open flowers, in the inner and outer rooms.
- 30 *And the floor of the house he overlaid with gold, within and without.* The floor of the house he overlaid with gold in the inner and outer rooms.
- 31 *And for the entering of the oracle he made doors of olive tree: the lintel and side posts were a fifth part of the wall.* For the entrance to the inner sanctuary he made doors of olivewood; the lintel and the doorposts formed a pentagonal frame.
- 32 *The two doors also were of olive tree; and he carved upon them carvings of cherubims and palm trees and open flowers, and overlaid them with gold, and spread gold upon the cherubims, and upon the palm trees.* He covered the two doors of olivewood with carvings of cherubim, palm trees, and open flowers. He overlaid them with gold and spread gold on the cherubim and on the palm trees.
- 33 *So also made he for the door of the temple posts of olive tree, a fourth part of the wall.* So also he made for the entrance to the nave doorposts of olivewood, in the form of a square,
- 34 *And the two doors were of fir tree: the two leaves of the one door were folding, and the two leaves of the other door were folding.* Two doors of cypress wood. The two leaves of the one door were folding, and the two leaves of the other door were folding.

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| <p>35 <i>And he carved thereon cherubims and palm trees and open flowers: and covered them with gold fitted upon the carved work.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And he built the inner court with three rows of hewed stone, and a row of cedar beams.</i></p> <p>37 <i>In the fourth year was the foundation of the house of the LORD laid, in the month Zif:</i></p> <p>38 <i>And in the eleventh year, in the month Bul, which is the eighth month, was the house finished throughout all the parts thereof, and according to all the fashion of it. So was he seven years in building it.</i></p> | <p>On them he carved cherubim and palm trees and open flowers. He overlaid them with gold evenly applied on the carved work.</p> <p>He built the inner court with three courses of cut stone and one course of cedar beams.</p> <p>In the fourth year the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid, in the month of Ziv.</p> <p>In the eleventh year, in the month of Bul, which is the eighth month, the house was finished in all its parts, and according to all its specifications. He was seven years in building it.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Chr 3:1-2

v4 — Ezek 40:16

v5 — 1 Kgs 6:16

v7 — Deut 27:5-6; 1 Pet 2:5

v9 — 1 Kgs 6:38; 1 Kgs 6:14

v12 — 1 Chr 22:10

v13 — Deut 31:6; Ex 25:8

v14 — 1 Kgs 6:9; 1 Kgs 6:38

v16 — 1 Kgs 8:6; 2 Chr 3:8

v23 — Ex 37:7-9

v27 — Ex 25:20; Ex 37:9

Chapter 7

Solomon built his own palace complex over thirteen years, including the House of the Forest of Lebanon and the hall of judgment. Hiram of Tyre cast the two bronze pillars, the molten sea, and the bronze vessels for the temple.

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| 1 | <i>But Solomon was building his own house thirteen years, and he finished all his house.</i> | Solomon was building his own house thirteen years. He finished his entire house. |
| 2 | <i>He built also the house of the forest of Lebanon; the length thereof was an hundred cubits, and the breadth thereof fifty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits, upon four rows of cedar pillars, with cedar beams upon the pillars.</i> | He built the House of the Forest of Lebanon. Its length was a hundred cubits and its breadth fifty cubits and its height thirty cubits. It was built on four rows of cedar pillars, with cedar beams on the pillars. |
| 3 | <i>And it was covered with cedar above upon the beams, that lay on forty five pillars, fifteen in a row.</i> | It was covered with cedar above the chambers that were on the forty-five pillars, fifteen in each row. |
| 4 | <i>And there were windows in three rows, and light was against light in three ranks.</i> | There were window frames in three rows, and window opposite window in three tiers. |
| 5 | <i>And all the doors and posts were square, with the windows: and light was against light in three ranks.</i> | All the doorways and windows had square frames, and window was opposite window in three tiers. |
| 6 | <i>And he made a porch of pillars; the length thereof was fifty cubits, and the breadth thereof thirty cubits: and the porch was before them: and the other pillars and the thick beam were before them.</i> | He made the Hall of Pillars; its length was fifty cubits, and its breadth thirty cubits. There was a porch in front with pillars, and a canopy in front of them. |
| 7 | <i>Then he made a porch for the throne where he might judge, even the porch of judgment: and it was covered with cedar from one side of the floor to the other.</i> | He made the Hall of the Throne where he was to pronounce judgment, even the Hall of Judgment. It was finished with cedar from floor to rafters. |

- 8 *And his house where he dwelt had another court within the porch, which was of the like work. Solomon made also an house for Pharaoh's daughter, whom he had taken to wife, like unto this porch.* His own house where he was to dwell, in the other court back of the hall, was of like workmanship. Solomon also made a house like this hall for Pharaoh's daughter whom he had taken in marriage.
- 9 *All these were of costly stones, according to the measures of hewed stones, sawed with saws, within and without, even from the foundation unto the coping, and so on the outside toward the great court.* All these were made of costly stones, cut according to measure, sawed with saws, back and front, even from the foundation to the coping, and from the outside to the great court.
- 10 *And the foundation was of costly stones, even great stones, stones of ten cubits, and stones of eight cubits.* The foundation was of costly stones, huge stones, stones of eight and ten cubits.
- 11 *And above were costly stones, after the measures of hewed stones, and cedars.* Above were costly stones, cut according to measurement, and cedar.
- 12 *And the great court round about was with three rows of hewed stones, and a row of cedar beams, both for the inner court of the house of the LORD, and for the porch of the house.* The great court had three courses of cut stone all around and a course of cedar beams; so had the inner court of the house of the LORD and the vestibule of the house.
- 13 *And king Solomon sent and fetched Hiram out of Tyre.* King Solomon sent and brought Hiram from Tyre.
- 14 *He was a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali, and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in brass: and he was filled with wisdom, and understanding, and cunning to work all works in brass. And he came to king Solomon, and wrought all his work.* He was the son of a widow of the tribe of Naphtali. His father was a man of Tyre, a worker in bronze. And he was full of wisdom, understanding, and skill for making any work in bronze. He came to King Solomon and did all his work.

- 15 *For he cast two pillars of brass, of eighteen cubits high apiece: and a line of twelve cubits did compass either of them about.* He cast two pillars of bronze. Eighteen cubits was the height of one pillar, and a line of twelve cubits measured its circumference.
- 16 *And he made two chapters of molten brass, to set upon the tops of the pillars: the height of the one chapter was five cubits, and the height of the other chapter was five cubits:* He also made two capitals of cast bronze to set on the tops of the pillars. The height of the one capital was five cubits, and the height of the other capital was five cubits.
- 17 *And nets of checker work, and wreaths of chain work, for the chapters which were upon the top of the pillars; seven for the one chapter, and seven for the other chapter.* There were lattices of checker work with wreaths of chain work for the capitals on the tops of the pillars, a lattice for the one capital and a lattice for the other capital.
- 18 *And he made the pillars, and two rows round about upon the one network, to cover the chapters that were upon the top, with pomegranates: and so did he for the other chapter.* Likewise he made pomegranates in two rows around the one latticework to cover the capital that was on the top of the one pillar. He did the same with the other capital.
- 19 *And the chapters that were upon the top of the pillars were of lily work in the porch, four cubits.* Now the capitals that were on the tops of the pillars in the vestibule were of lily-work, four cubits.
- 20 *And the chapters upon the two pillars had pomegranates also above, over against the belly which was by the network: and the pomegranates were two hundred in rows round about upon the other chapter.* The capitals were on the two pillars and also above the rounded projection that was beside the lattice-work. There were 200 pomegranates in two rows around each capital.
- 21 *And he set up the pillars in the porch of the temple: and he set up the right pillar, and called the name thereof Jachin: and he set up the left pillar, and called the name thereof Boaz.* He set up the pillars at the vestibule of the temple. He set up the right pillar and called its name Jachin. He set up the left pillar and called its name Boaz.

- 22 *And upon the top of the pillars was lily work: so was the work of the pillars finished.* On the tops of the pillars was lily-work. Thus the work of the pillars was finished.
- 23 *And he made a molten sea, ten cubits from the one brim to the other: it was round all about, and his height was five cubits: and a line of thirty cubits did compass it round about.* Then he made the sea of cast metal. It was round, ten cubits from brim to brim, and five cubits high, and a line of thirty cubits measured its circumference.
- 24 *And under the brim of it round about there were knops compassing it, ten in a cubit, compassing the sea round about: the knops were cast in two rows, when it was cast.* Under its brim were gourds, for ten cubits, compassing the sea all around. The gourds were in two rows, cast with it when it was cast.
- 25 *It stood upon twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, and three looking toward the west, and three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east: and the sea was set above upon them, and all their hinder parts were inward.* It stood on twelve oxen, three facing north, three facing west, three facing south, and three facing east. The sea was set on them. All their rear parts were inward.
- 26 *And it was an hand breadth thick, and the brim thereof was wrought like the brim of a cup, with flowers of lilies: it contained two thousand baths.* Its thickness was a handbreadth, and its brim was made like the brim of a cup, like the flower of a lily. It held two thousand baths.
- 27 *And he made ten bases of brass; four cubits was the length of one base, and four cubits the breadth thereof, and three cubits the height of it.* He also made the ten stands of bronze. Each stand was four cubits long, four cubits wide, and three cubits high.
- 28 *And the work of the bases was on this manner: they had borders, and the borders were between the ledges:* This was the construction of the stands: they had panels, and the panels were set in the frames,

- 29 *And on the borders that were between the ledges were lions, oxen, and cherubims: and upon the ledges there was a base above: and beneath the lions and oxen were certain additions made of thin work.* On the panels that were set in the frames were lions, oxen, and cherubim. On the frames, both above and below the lions and oxen, there were wreaths of hanging work.
- 30 *And every base had four brasen wheels, and plates of brass: and the four corners thereof had undersetters: under the laver were undersetters molten, at the side of every addition.* Each stand had four bronze wheels and axles of bronze, and at the four corners were supports for a basin. The supports were cast with wreaths at the side of each.
- 31 *And the mouth of it within the chapter and above was a cubit: but the mouth thereof was round after the work of the base, a cubit and an half: and also upon the mouth of it were gravings with their borders, foursquare, not round.* Its opening was within the crown and above it was a cubit high; its opening was round, as a pedestal is made, a cubit and a half deep. At its opening there were carvings, and its panels were square, not round.
- 32 *And under the borders were four wheels; and the axletrees of the wheels were joined to the base: and the height of a wheel was a cubit and half a cubit.* The four wheels were underneath the panels. The axles of the wheels were in the stand, and the height of a wheel was a cubit and a half.
- 33 *And the work of the wheels was like the work of a chariot wheel: their axletrees, and their naves, and their felloes, and their spokes, were all molten.* The wheels were made like a chariot wheel; their axles, their rims, their spokes. Their hubs were all cast.
- 34 *And there were four undersetters to the four corners of one base: and the undersetters were of the very base itself.* There were four supports at the four corners of each stand. The supports were of one piece with the stand.

- 35 *And in the top of the base was there a round compass of half a cubit high: and on the top of the base the ledges thereof and the borders thereof were of the same.* On the top of the stand there was a round band half a cubit high, and on the top of the stand its stays and its panels were of one piece with it.
- 36 *For on the plates of the ledges thereof, and on the borders thereof, he graved cherubims, lions, and palm trees, according to the proportion of every one, and additions round about.* On the surfaces of its stays and on its panels, he carved cherubim, lions, and palm trees, according to the space of each, with wreaths all around.
- 37 *After this manner he made the ten bases: all of them had one casting, one measure, and one size.* After this manner he made the ten stands. All of them were cast alike, of the same measure and the same form.
- 38 *Then made he ten lavers of brass: one laver contained forty baths: and every laver was four cubits: and upon every one of the ten bases one laver.* He made ten basins of bronze. Each basin held forty baths, each basin measured four cubits, and there was a basin for each of the ten stands.
- 39 *And he put five bases on the right side of the house, and five on the left side of the house: and he set the sea on the right side of the house eastward over against the south.* He set five of the stands on the south side of the house, and five on the north side of the house. And he set the sea on the southeast corner of the house.
- 40 *And Hiram made the lavers, and the shovels, and the basons. So Hiram made an end of doing all the work that he made king Solomon for the house of the LORD:* Hiram also made the pots, the shovels, and the basins. So Hiram finished all the work that He did for King Solomon on the house of the LORD:
- 41 *The two pillars, and the two bowls of the chapters that were on the top of the two pillars; and the two networks, to cover the two bowls of the chapters which were upon the top of the pillars;* The two pillars, the two bowls of the capitals that were on the tops of the pillars, and the two lattice-works to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the tops of the pillars;

- 42 *And four hundred pomegranates for the two networks, even two rows of pomegranates for one network, to cover the two bowls of the chapters that were upon the pillars;* The 400 pomegranates for the two lattice-works, two rows of pomegranates for each lattice-work, to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the pillars;
- 43 *And the ten bases, and ten lavers on the bases;* The ten stands, and the ten basins on the stands;
- 44 *And one sea, and twelve oxen under the sea;* The one sea, and the twelve oxen underneath the sea;
- 45 *And the pots, and the shovels, and the basons: and all these vessels, which Hiram made to king Solomon for the house of the LORD, were of bright brass.* The pots, the shovels, and the basins. All these vessels that Hiram made for King Solomon for the house of the LORD were of burnished bronze.
- 46 *In the plain of Jordan did the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zarthan.* In the plain of the Jordan the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zarethan.
- 47 *And Solomon left all the vessels unweighed, because they were exceeding many: neither was the weight of the brass found out.* Solomon left all the vessels unweighed, because there were so many of them; the weight of the bronze was not determined.
- 48 *And Solomon made all the vessels that pertained unto the house of the LORD: the altar of gold, and the table of gold, whereupon the shewbread was,* So Solomon made all the vessels that were in the house of the LORD: the golden altar, the golden table for the bread of the Presence,
- 49 *And the candlesticks of pure gold, five on the right side, and five on the left, before the oracle, with the flowers, and the lamps, and the tongs of gold,* The lampstands of pure gold, five on the south side and five on the north, before the inner sanctuary; the flowers, the lamps, and the tongs, of gold;

- 50 *And the bowls, and the snuffers, and the basons, and the spoons, and the censers of pure gold; and the hinges of gold, both for the doors of the inner house, the most holy place, and for the doors of the house, to wit, of the temple.* The cups, snuffers, basins, dishes for incense, and fire pans, of pure gold. The sockets of gold, for the doors of the innermost part of the house, the Most Holy Place, and for the doors of the nave of the temple.
- 51 *So was ended all the work that king Solomon made for the house of the LORD. And Solomon brought in the things which David his father had dedicated; even the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, did he put among the treasures of the house of the LORD.* Thus all the work that King Solomon did on the house of the LORD was finished. And Solomon brought in the things that David his father had dedicated, the silver, the gold, and the vessels, and stored them in the treasuries of the house of the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

laver (*LAY-ver*) — The large bronze basin in the tabernacle courtyard — priests washed their hands and feet here before approaching God's altar.

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Boaz (*BO-az*) — A wealthy landowner in Bethlehem who married Ruth — he acted as her kinsman-redeemer; ancestor of King David; his name means 'in him is strength.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 9:10; 2 Chr 8:1

v2 — 1 Kgs 10:17

v7 — Prov 20:8; Ps 122:5

v8 — 2 Chr 8:11; 1 Kgs 3:1

v12 — 1 Kgs 6:36

v15 — Jer 52:21

v20 — 2 Chr 3:16; 2 Chr 4:13

v21 — 2 Chr 3:17

v23 — 2 Chr 4:2; 2 Kgs 25:13

v25 — Jer 52:20

v27 — 2 Chr 4:14

v45 — Ex 27:3

Chapter 8

Solomon assembled Israel and brought the ark into the temple, and the glory of the LORD filled the house. Solomon dedicated the temple with a lengthy prayer and offered 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep as peace offerings.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the fathers of the children of Israel, unto king Solomon in Jerusalem, that they might bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto king Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And all the elders of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And they brought up the ark of the LORD, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in the tabernacle, even those did the priests and the Levites bring up.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And king Solomon, and all the congregation of Israel, that were assembled unto him, were with him before the ark, sacrificing sheep and oxen, that could not be told nor numbered for multitude.</i></p> | <p>Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel and all the heads of the tribes, the leaders of the fathers' houses of the people of Israel, before King Solomon in Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion.</p> <p>All the men of Israel assembled to King Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month.</p> <p>All the elders of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark.</p> <p>They brought up the ark of the LORD, the tent of meeting. All the holy vessels that were in the tent; the priests and the Levites brought them up.</p> <p>King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel, who had assembled before him, were with him before the ark, sacrificing so many sheep and oxen that they could not be counted or numbered.</p> |
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- 6 *And the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the LORD unto his place, into the oracle of the house, to the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubims.* Then the priests brought the ark of the covenant of the LORD to its place in the inner sanctuary of the house, in the Most Holy Place, underneath the wings of the cherubim.
- 7 *For the cherubims spread forth their two wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubims covered the ark and the staves thereof above.* For the cherubim spread out their wings over the place of the ark, so that the cherubim overshadowed the ark and its poles.
- 8 *And the staves were so long that the ends of the staves were seen out in the holy place before the oracle, and they were not seen without: and there they are unto this day.* The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the Holy Place before the inner sanctuary; but they could not be seen from outside. And they are there to this day.
- 9 *There was nothing in the ark save the two tables of stone, which Moses put there at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt.* There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets of stone that Moses put there at Horeb, where the LORD made a covenant with the people of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt.
- 10 *And it came to pass, when the priests were come out of the holy place, that the cloud filled the house of the LORD,* When the priests came out of the Holy Place, a cloud filled the house of the LORD,
- 11 *So that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud: for the glory of the LORD had filled the house of the LORD.* So that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled the house of the LORD.
- 12 *Then spake Solomon, The LORD said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.* Then Solomon said, "The LORD has said that He would dwell in thick darkness.
- 13 *I have surely built thee an house to dwell in, a settled place for thee to abide in for ever.* I have indeed built You an exalted house, a place for You to dwell in forever."

- 14 *And the king turned his face about, and blessed all the congregation of Israel: (and all the congregation of Israel stood;)* Then the king turned around and blessed all the assembly of Israel, while all the assembly of Israel stood.
- 15 *And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which spake with his mouth unto David my father, and hath with his hand fulfilled it, saying,* He said, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who with his hand has fulfilled what he promised with his mouth to David my father, saying,
- 16 *Since the day that I brought forth my people Israel out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel to build an house, that my name might be therein; but I chose David to be over my people Israel.* 'Since the day that I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel in which to build a house, that my name might be there. But I chose David to be over my people Israel.'
- 17 *And it was in the heart of David my father to build an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.* Now it was in the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 18 *And the LORD said unto David my father, Whereas it was in thine heart to build an house unto my name, thou didst well that it was in thine heart.* But the LORD said to David my father, 'Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart.
- 19 *Nevertheless thou shalt not build the house; but thy son that shall come forth out of thy loins, he shall build the house unto my name.* Nevertheless, You shall not build the house, but Your son who shall be born to You shall build the house for my name.'
- 20 *And the LORD hath performed his word that he spake, and I am risen up in the room of David my father, and sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised, and have built an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.* Now the LORD has fulfilled His promise that He made. For I have risen in the place of David my father, and sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised. I have built the house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.

- 21 *And I have set there a place for the ark, wherein is the covenant of the LORD, which he made with our fathers, when he brought them out of the land of Egypt.* There I have provided a place for the ark, in which is the covenant of the LORD that He made with our fathers, when He brought them out of the land of Egypt."
- 22 *And Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands toward heaven:* Then Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the assembly of Israel and spread out His hands toward heaven,
- 23 *And he said, LORD God of Israel, there is no God like thee, in heaven above, or on earth beneath, who keepest covenant and mercy with thy servants that walk before thee with all their heart:* And He said, "O LORD, God of Israel, there is no God like You, in heaven above or on earth beneath, keeping covenant and showing mercy to Your servants who walk before You with all their heart;
- 24 *Who hast kept with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him: thou spakest also with thy mouth, and hast fulfilled it with thine hand, as it is this day.* You have kept with your servant David my father what you declared to him. You spoke with your mouth, and with your hand have fulfilled it this day.
- 25 *Therefore now, LORD God of Israel, keep with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him, saying, There shall not fail thee a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel; so that thy children take heed to their way, that they walk before me as thou hast walked before me.* Now therefore, O LORD, God of Israel, keep for Your servant David my father what you have promised him, saying, 'You shall not lack a man to sit before me on the throne of Israel, if only Your sons pay close attention to their way, to walk before me as You have walked before me.'
- 26 *And now, O God of Israel, let thy word, I pray thee, be verified, which thou spakest unto thy servant David my father.* Now therefore, O God of Israel, let Your word be confirmed, which You have spoken to Your servant David my father.

- 27 *But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?* But will God indeed dwell on the earth? heaven and the highest heaven cannot contain you; how much less this house that I have built!
- 28 *Yet have thou respect unto the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplication, O LORD my God, to hearken unto the cry and to the prayer, which thy servant prayeth before thee to day:* Yet have regard to the prayer of Your servant and to His plea, O LORD my God, listening to the cry and to the prayer that Your servant prays before You this day,
- 29 *That thine eyes may be open toward this house night and day, even toward the place of which thou hast said, My name shall be there: that thou mayest hearken unto the prayer which thy servant shall make toward this place.* That Your eyes may be open night and day toward this house, the place of which You have said, 'My name shall be there,' that You may listen to the prayer that Your servant offers toward this place.
- 30 *And hearken thou to the supplication of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, when they shall pray toward this place: and hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place: and when thou hearest, forgive.* Listen to the plea of Your servant and of Your people Israel, when they pray toward this place. And listen in heaven Your dwelling place, and when You hear, forgive.
- 31 *If any man trespass against his neighbour, and an oath be laid upon him to cause him to swear, and the oath come before thine altar in this house:* If a man sins against his neighbor and is made to take an oath and comes and swears His oath before Your altar in this house,
- 32 *Then hear thou in heaven, and do, and judge thy servants, condemning the wicked, to bring his way upon his head; and justifying the righteous, to give him according to his righteousness.* Then hear in heaven and act and judge Your servants, condemning the guilty by bringing His conduct on His own head, and vindicating the righteous by rewarding him according to his righteousness.

- 33 *When thy people Israel be smitten down before the enemy, because they have sinned against thee, and shall turn again to thee, and confess thy name, and pray, and make supplication unto thee in this house:* When Your people Israel are defeated before the enemy because they have sinned against you, and if they turn again to You and acknowledge Your name and pray and plead with You in this house,
- 34 *Then hear thou in heaven, and forgive the sin of thy people Israel, and bring them again unto the land which thou gavest unto their fathers.* Then hear in heaven and forgive the sin of Your people Israel and bring them back to the land that You gave to their fathers.
- 35 *When heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against thee; if they pray toward this place, and confess thy name, and turn from their sin, when thou afflictest them:* When heaven is shut up and there is no rain because they have sinned against You, if they pray toward this place and acknowledge Your name and turn from their sin, when You afflict them,
- 36 *Then hear thou in heaven, and forgive the sin of thy servants, and of thy people Israel, that thou teach them the good way wherein they should walk, and give rain upon thy land, which thou hast given to thy people for an inheritance.* Then hear in heaven and forgive the sin of Your servants, Your people Israel, when You teach them the good way in which they should walk, and grant rain upon Your land, which You have given to Your people as an inheritance.
- 37 *If there be in the land famine, if there be pestilence, blasting, mildew, locust, or if there be caterpillar; if their enemy besiege them in the land of their cities; whatsoever plague, whatsoever sickness there be;* If there is famine in the land, if there is pestilence or blight or mildew or locust or caterpillar, if their enemy besieges them in the land at their gates, whatever plague, whatever sickness there is,
- 38 *What prayer and supplication soever be made by any man, or by all thy people Israel, which shall know every man the plague of his own heart, and spread forth his hands toward this house:* Whatever prayer, whatever plea is made by any man or by all Your people Israel, each knowing the affliction of His own heart and stretching out His hands toward this house,

- 39 *Then hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place, and forgive, and do, and give to every man according to his ways, whose heart thou knowest; (for thou, even thou only, knowest the hearts of all the children of men;)* Then hear in heaven Your dwelling place and forgive and act and render to each whose heart You know, according to all His ways (for You, You only, know the hearts of all the children of mankind),
- 40 *That they may fear thee all the days that they live in the land which thou gavest unto our fathers.* That they may fear You all the days that they live in the land that You gave to our fathers.
- 41 *Moreover concerning a stranger, that is not of thy people Israel, but cometh out of a far country for thy name's sake;* Likewise, when a foreigner, who is not of Your people Israel, comes from a far country for Your name's sake
- 42 *(For they shall hear of thy great name, and of thy strong hand, and of thy stretched out arm;) when he shall come and pray toward this house;* (for they shall hear of Your great name and Your mighty hand, and of Your outstretched arm), when He comes and prays toward this house,
- 43 *Hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place, and do according to all that the stranger calleth to thee for: that all people of the earth may know thy name, to fear thee, as do thy people Israel; and that they may know that this house, which I have builded, is called by thy name.* Hear in heaven Your dwelling place and do according to all for which the foreigner calls to You, in order that all the peoples of the earth may know Your name and fear You, as do Your people Israel, and that they may know that this house that I have built is called by Your name.
- 44 *If thy people go out to battle against their enemy, whithersoever thou shalt send them, and shall pray unto the LORD toward the city which thou hast chosen, and toward the house that I have built for thy name:* If Your people go out to battle against their enemy, by whatever way You shall send them. They pray to the LORD toward the city that You have chosen and the house that I have built for Your name,
- 45 *Then hear thou in heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.* Then hear in heaven their prayer and their plea, and maintain their cause.

- 46 *If they sin against thee, (for there is no man that sinneth not,) and thou be angry with them, and deliver them to the enemy, so that they carry them away captives unto the land of the enemy, far or near;* If they sin against You—for there is no one who does not sin—and you are angry with them and give them to an enemy, so that they are carried away captive to the land of the enemy, far off or near,
- 47 *Yet if they shall bethink themselves in the land whither they were carried captives, and repent, and make supplication unto thee in the land of them that carried them captives, saying, We have sinned, and have done perversely, we have committed wickedness;* Yet if they turn their heart in the land to which they have been carried captive, and repent and plead with You in the land of their captors, saying, 'We have sinned and have acted perversely and wickedly,'
- 48 *And so return unto thee with all their heart, and with all their soul, in the land of their enemies, which led them away captive, and pray unto thee toward their land, which thou gavest unto their fathers, the city which thou hast chosen, and the house which I have built for thy name:* If they repent with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their enemies who carried them captive, and pray to You toward their land, which You gave to their fathers, the city that You have chosen, and the house that I have built for Your name,
- 49 *Then hear thou their prayer and their supplication in heaven thy dwelling place, and maintain their cause,* Then hear in heaven Your dwelling place their prayer and their plea, and maintain their cause
- 50 *And forgive thy people that have sinned against thee, and all their transgressions wherein they have transgressed against thee, and give them compassion before them who carried them captive, that they may have compassion on them:* Forgive Your people who have sinned against You. All their transgressions that they have committed against You, and grant them compassion in the sight of those who carried them captive, that they may have compassion on them

- 51 *For they be thy people, and thine inheritance, which thou broughtest forth out of Egypt, from the midst of the furnace of iron:* (for they are Your people, and Your heritage, which You brought out of Egypt, from the midst of the iron furnace),
- 52 *That thine eyes may be open unto the supplication of thy servant, and unto the supplication of thy people Israel, to hearken unto them in all that they call for unto thee.* That Your eyes may be open to the plea of Your servant and to the plea of Your people Israel, giving ear to them whenever they call to You.
- 53 *For thou didst separate them from among all the people of the earth, to be thine inheritance, as thou spakest by the hand of Moses thy servant, when thou broughtest our fathers out of Egypt, O Lord GOD.* For You separated them from among all the peoples of the earth to be Your heritage, as You declared through Moses your servant, when you brought our fathers out of Egypt, O Lord GOD."
- 54 *And it was so, that when Solomon had made an end of praying all this prayer and supplication unto the LORD, he arose from before the altar of the LORD, from kneeling on his knees with his hands spread up to heaven.* Now as Solomon finished offering all this prayer and plea to the LORD, He arose from before the altar of the LORD, where He had knelt with hands outstretched toward heaven.
- 55 *And he stood, and blessed all the congregation of Israel with a loud voice, saying,* He stood and blessed all the assembly of Israel with a loud voice, saying,
- 56 *Blessed be the LORD, that hath given rest unto his people Israel, according to all that he promised: there hath not failed one word of all his good promise, which he promised by the hand of Moses his servant.* "Blessed be the LORD Who has given rest to His people Israel, according to all that He promised. Not one word has failed of all His good promise, which He spoke by Moses his servant.
- 57 *The LORD our God be with us, as he was with our fathers: let him not leave us, nor forsake us:* The LORD our God be with us, as He was with our fathers. May He not leave us or forsake us,

- 58 *That he may incline our hearts unto him, to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, and his statutes, and his judgments, which he commanded our fathers.* That He may incline our hearts to Him, to walk in all His ways and to keep His commandments, His statutes. His rules, which He commanded our fathers.
- 59 *And let these my words, wherewith I have made supplication before the LORD, be nigh unto the LORD our God day and night, that he maintain the cause of his servant, and the cause of his people Israel at all times, as the matter shall require:* Let these words of mine, with which I have pleaded before the LORD, be near to the LORD our God day and night, and may He maintain the cause of His servant and the cause of his people Israel, as each day requires,
- 60 *That all the people of the earth may know that the LORD is God, and that there is none else.* That all the peoples of the earth may know that the LORD is God; there is no other.
- 61 *Let your heart therefore be perfect with the LORD our God, to walk in his statutes, and to keep his commandments, as at this day.* Let Your heart therefore be wholly true to the LORD our God, walking in His statutes and keeping His commandments, as at this day."
- 62 *And the king, and all Israel with him, offered sacrifice before the LORD.* Then the king. All Israel with him, offered sacrifice before the LORD.
- 63 *And Solomon offered a sacrifice of peace offerings, which he offered unto the LORD, two and twenty thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the children of Israel dedicated the house of the LORD.* Solomon offered as peace offerings to the LORD 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep. So the king and all the people of Israel dedicated the house of the LORD.

- 64 *The same day did the king hallow the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD: for there he offered burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings: because the brasen altar that was before the LORD was too little to receive the burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings.* The same day the king consecrated the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD, for there He offered the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat pieces of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar that was before the LORD was too small to receive the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat pieces of the peace offerings.
- 65 *And at that time Solomon held a feast, and all Israel with him, a great congregation, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt, before the LORD our God, seven days and seven days, even fourteen days.* So Solomon held the feast at that time, and all Israel with Him, a great assembly, from the entering in of Hamath to the river of Egypt, before the LORD our God, seven days and seven days, even fourteen days.
- 66 *On the eighth day he sent the people away: and they blessed the king, and went unto their tents joyful and glad of heart for all the goodness that the LORD had done for David his servant, and for Israel his people.* On the eighth day He sent the people away. They blessed the king and went to their homes joyful and glad of heart for all the goodness that the LORD had shown to David his servant and to Israel his people.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Horeb (*HOR-eb*) — Another name for Mount Sinai — the mountain where God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and later where Elijah fled from Jezebel.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v9 — Ex 25:21; Heb 9:4; Ex 40:20

v12 — Ps 97:2; 2 Chr 6:1-11; Lev 16:2; Isa 45:15; Ps 18:8-11

v23 — 2 Sam 7:22; Deut 7:9; Dan 9:4; Neh 1:5; 1 Sam 2:2

v26 — 2 Sam 7:25-29; 1 Kgs 8:23; Ps 119:49; Isa 41:17; Ps 41:13

v27 — 2 Chr 2:6; Isa 66:1; Jer 23:24; 2 Chr 6:18; Acts 7:48-49

v39 — 1 Chr 28:9; Jer 17:10; 1 Sam 16:7; Acts 1:24

v46 — Eccl 7:20; Prov 20:9; Isa 64:6; Isa 53:6; 1 John 1:8-10

v56 — Josh 23:14-15; Josh 21:44-45; Luke 21:33; 1 Sam 3:19; Luke 1:72-73

v57 — Josh 1:5; Deut 31:6; Heb 13:5; Deut 31:8; Josh 1:9

v58 — Ps 119:36; Ezek 36:26-27; Jer 31:33; Phil 2:13

v60 — Deut 4:35; 2 Kgs 19:19; Jer 10:10-12; 1 Kgs 18:39; Isa 44:8

v61 — 1 Kgs 11:4; 2 Kgs 20:3; 1 Kgs 15:14; 1 Kgs 15:3; 2 Cor 7:1

Chapter 9

The LORD appeared to Solomon a second time, promising to establish his throne if he obeyed but warning that disobedience would bring judgment. Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in Galilee, built store cities, and organized forced labor from the remaining Canaanites.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, when Solomon had finished the building of the house of the LORD, and the king's house, and all Solomon's desire which he was pleased to do,</i></p> | <p>As soon as Solomon had finished building the house of the LORD and the king's house and all that Solomon desired to build,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>That the LORD appeared to Solomon the second time, as he had appeared unto him at Gibeon.</i></p> | <p>The LORD appeared to Solomon a second time, as he had appeared to him at Gibeon.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And the LORD said unto him, I have heard thy prayer and thy supplication, that thou hast made before me: I have hallowed this house, which thou hast built, to put my name there for ever; and mine eyes and mine heart shall be there perpetually.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Him, "I have heard Your prayer and Your plea, which You have made before me. I have consecrated this house that You have built, by putting my name there forever. My eyes and my heart will be there for all time.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And if thou wilt walk before me, as David thy father walked, in integrity of heart, and in uprightness, to do according to all that I have commanded thee, and wilt keep my statutes and my judgments:</i></p> | <p>As for you, if you will walk before me, as David your father walked, with integrity of heart and uprightness, doing according to all that I have commanded you, and keeping my statutes and my rules,</p> |

- 5 *Then I will establish the throne of thy kingdom upon Israel for ever, as I promised to David thy father, saying, There shall not fail thee a man upon the throne of Israel.* Then I will establish your royal throne over Israel forever, as I promised David your father, saying, 'You shall not lack a man on the throne of Israel.'
- 6 *But if ye shall at all turn from following me, ye or your children, and will not keep my commandments and my statutes which I have set before you, but go and serve other gods, and worship them:* But if you turn aside from following me, you or your children, and do not keep my commandments and my statutes that I have set before you, but go and serve other gods and worship them,
- 7 *Then will I cut off Israel out of the land which I have given them; and this house, which I have hallowed for my name, will I cast out of my sight; and Israel shall be a proverb and a byword among all people:* Then I will cut off Israel from the land that I have given them, and the house that I have consecrated for my name I will cast out of my sight. Israel will become a proverb and a byword among all peoples.
- 8 *And at this house, which is high, every one that passeth by it shall be astonished, and shall hiss; and they shall say, Why hath the LORD done thus unto this land, and to this house?* This house will become a heap of ruins. Everyone passing by it will be astonished and will hiss. They will say, 'Why has the LORD done thus to this land and to this house?'
- 9 *And they shall answer, Because they forsook the LORD their God, who brought forth their fathers out of the land of Egypt, and have taken hold upon other gods, and have worshipped them, and served them: therefore hath the LORD brought upon them all this evil.* Then they will say, 'Because they abandoned the LORD their God Who brought their fathers out of the land of Egypt and laid hold on other gods and worshiped them and served them. Therefore the LORD has brought all this disaster on them.' "
- 10 *And it came to pass at the end of twenty years, when Solomon had built the two houses, the house of the LORD, and the king's house,* At the end of twenty years, in which Solomon had built the two houses, the house of the LORD and the king's house,

- 11 *(Now Hiram the king of Tyre had furnished Solomon with cedar trees and fir trees, and with gold, according to all his desire,) that then king Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee.* Hiram king of Tyre had supplied Solomon with cedar and cypress timber and gold, as much as he desired, King Solomon gave to Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee.
- 12 *And Hiram came out from Tyre to see the cities which Solomon had given him; and they pleased him not.* But when Hiram came from Tyre to see the cities that Solomon had given him, they did not please him.
- 13 *And he said, What cities are these which thou hast given me, my brother? And he called them the land of Cabul unto this day.* Therefore he said, "What kind of cities are these that you have given me, my brother?" So they are called the land of Cabul to this day.
- 14 *And Hiram sent to the king sixscore talents of gold.* Hiram had sent to the king 120 talents of gold.
- 15 *And this is the reason of the levy which king Solomon raised; for to build the house of the LORD, and his own house, and Millo, and the wall of Jerusalem, and Hazor, and Megiddo, and Gezer.* This is the account of the forced labor that King Solomon drafted to build the house of the LORD and His own house and the Millo and the wall of Jerusalem and Hazor and Megiddo and Gezer
- 16 *For Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up, and taken Gezer, and burnt it with fire, and slain the Canaanites that dwelt in the city, and given it for a present unto his daughter, Solomon's wife.* (Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up and captured Gezer and burned it with fire, and had killed the Canaanites who lived in the city, and had given it as dowry to his daughter, Solomon's wife;
- 17 *And Solomon built Gezer, and Bethhoron the nether,* So Solomon rebuilt Gezer) and Lower Beth-horon
- 18 *And Baalath, and Tadmor in the wilderness, in the land,* Baalath and Tadmor in the wilderness, in the land,

- 19 *And all the cities of store that Solomon had, and cities for his chariots, and cities for his horsemen, and that which Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion.* All the store cities that Solomon had, and the cities for his chariots, and the cities for his horsemen, and whatever Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion.
- 20 *And all the people that were left of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, which were not of the children of Israel,* All the people who were left of the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were not of the people of Israel—
- 21 *Their children that were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel also were not able utterly to destroy, upon those did Solomon levy a tribute of bondservice unto this day.* Their descendants who were left after them in the land, whom the people of Israel were unable to devote to destruction—these Solomon drafted to be slaves, and so they are to this day.
- 22 *But of the children of Israel did Solomon make no bondmen: but they were men of war, and his servants, and his princes, and his captains, and rulers of his chariots, and his horsemen.* But of the people of Israel Solomon made no slaves. They were the soldiers, they were his officials, his commanders, his captains, his chariot commanders. His horsemen.
- 23 *These were the chief of the officers that were over Solomon's work, five hundred and fifty, which bare rule over the people that wrought in the work.* These were the chief officers who were over Solomon's work: 550 who had charge of the people who carried on the work.
- 24 *But Pharaoh's daughter came up out of the city of David unto her house which Solomon had built for her: then did he build Millo.* But Pharaoh's daughter went up from the city of David to her own house that Solomon had built for her. Then he built the Millo.

- 25 *And three times in a year did Solomon offer burnt offerings and peace offerings upon the altar which he built unto the LORD, and he burnt incense upon the altar that was before the LORD. So he finished the house.* Three times a year Solomon used to offer up burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar that He built to the LORD, making offerings with it before the LORD. So He finished the house.
- 26 *And king Solomon made a navy of ships in Eziongeber, which is beside Eloth, on the shore of the Red sea, in the land of Edom.* King Solomon built a fleet of ships at Ezion-geber, which is near Eloth on the shore of the Red Sea, in the land of Edom.
- 27 *And Hiram sent in the navy his servants, shipmen that had knowledge of the sea, with the servants of Solomon.* Hiram sent with the fleet his servants, seamen who were familiar with the sea, together with the servants of Solomon.
- 28 *And they came to Ophir, and fetched from thence gold, four hundred and twenty talents, and brought it to king Solomon.* They went to Ophir and brought from there gold, 420 talents. They delivered it to King Solomon.

Words in this chapter:

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Kgs 3:5; 2 Chr 7:12; 1 Kgs 11:9
v3 — 2 Kgs 20:5; 1 John 5:14; 1 Kgs 8:29; Ps 10:17; Ps 116:1
v4 — 1 Kgs 15:5; 1 Kgs 3:14; Gen 17:1; 1 Kgs 11:6; 1 Kgs 11:4
v5 — 1 Kgs 2:4; 1 Kgs 6:12
v7 — Ps 44:14; Jer 24:9; Deut 4:26; Deut 28:37
v8 — Jer 22:8-9; Deut 29:24-26
v9 — Jer 2:19
v15 — Josh 17:11; 1 Kgs 9:24; 1 Kgs 5:13; 2 Sam 5:9
v21 — Josh 15:63; Josh 17:12; Judg 1:21
v24 — 1 Kgs 7:8; 2 Chr 32:5; 2 Sam 5:9; 1 Kgs 11:27
v26 — 1 Kgs 22:48; Deut 2:8; Num 33:35
v28 — 2 Chr 8:18; 1 Chr 29:4

Chapter 10

The queen of Sheba visited Solomon and was overwhelmed by his wisdom and wealth, declaring that the half had not been told. Solomon's annual income was 666 talents of gold; he made a great ivory throne and surpassed all kings in riches.

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| 1 | <i>And when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon concerning the name of the LORD, she came to prove him with hard questions.</i> | Now when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon concerning the name of the LORD, she came to test Him with hard questions. |
| 2 | <i>And she came to Jerusalem with a very great train, with camels that bare spices, and very much gold, and precious stones: and when she was come to Solomon, she communed with him of all that was in her heart.</i> | She came to Jerusalem with a very great retinue, with camels bearing spices and very much gold and precious stones. And when she came to Solomon, she told him all that was on her mind. |
| 3 | <i>And Solomon told her all her questions: there was not any thing hid from the king, which he told her not.</i> | Solomon answered all her questions; there was nothing hidden from the king that he could not explain to her. |
| 4 | <i>And when the queen of Sheba had seen all Solomon's wisdom, and the house that he had built,</i> | When the queen of Sheba had seen all the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had built, |

- 5 *And the meat of his table, and the sitting of his servants, and the attendance of his ministers, and their apparel, and his cupbearers, and his ascent by which he went up unto the house of the LORD; there was no more spirit in her.* The food of His table, the seating of His officials, and the attendance of His servants, their clothing, his cupbearers. His burnt offerings that He offered at the house of the LORD, there was no more breath in her.
- 6 *And she said to the king, It was a true report that I heard in mine own land of thy acts and of thy wisdom.* She said to the king, "The report was true that I heard in my own land of your words and of your wisdom,
- 7 *Howbeit I believed not the words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the half was not told me: thy wisdom and prosperity exceedeth the fame which I heard.* But I did not believe the reports until I came and my own eyes had seen it. And the half was not told me. Your wisdom and prosperity surpass the report that I heard.
- 8 *Happy are thy men, happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and that hear thy wisdom.* Happy are your men! Happy are your servants, who continually stand before you and hear your wisdom!
- 9 *Blessed be the LORD thy God, which delighted in thee, to set thee on the throne of Israel: because the LORD loved Israel for ever, therefore made he thee king, to do judgment and justice.* Blessed be the LORD Your God, Who has delighted in You and set You on the throne of Israel! Because the LORD loved Israel forever, He has made You king, that You may execute justice and righteousness."
- 10 *And she gave the king an hundred and twenty talents of gold, and of spices very great store, and precious stones: there came no more such abundance of spices as these which the queen of Sheba gave to king Solomon.* Then she gave the king 120 talents of gold, and a very great quantity of spices and precious stones. Never again came such an abundance of spices as these that the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon.
- 11 *And the navy also of Hiram, that brought gold from Ophir, brought in from Ophir great plenty of al mug trees, and precious stones.* Moreover, the fleet of Hiram, which brought gold from Ophir, brought from Ophir a very great amount of al mug wood and precious stones.

- 12 *And the king made of the almug trees pillars for the house of the LORD, and for the king's house, harps also and psalteries for singers: there came no such almug trees, nor were seen unto this day.* The king made of the almug wood supports for the house of the LORD and for the king's house, also lyres and harps for the singers. No such almug wood has come or been seen to this day.
- 13 *And king Solomon gave unto the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatsoever she asked, beside that which Solomon gave her of his royal bounty. So she turned and went to her own country, she and her servants.* King Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all that she desired, whatever she asked besides what was given her by the bounty of King Solomon. So she turned and went back to her own land with her servants.
- 14 *Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred threescore and six talents of gold,* Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was 666 talents of gold,
- 15 *Beside that he had of the merchantmen, and of the traffick of the spice merchants, and of all the kings of Arabia, and of the governors of the country.* Besides that which came from the explorers and from the business of the merchants, and from all the kings of Arabia and from the governors of the land.
- 16 *And king Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: six hundred shekels of gold went to one target.* King Solomon made 200 large shields of beaten gold; 600 shekels of gold went into each shield.
- 17 *And he made three hundred shields of beaten gold; three pounds of gold went to one shield: and the king put them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.* He made 300 shields of beaten gold; three minas of gold went into each shield. And the king put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.
- 18 *Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with the best gold.* The king also made a great ivory throne and overlaid it with the finest gold.

- 19 *The throne had six steps, and the top of the throne was round behind: and there were stays on either side on the place of the seat, and two lions stood beside the stays.* The throne had six steps, and the throne had a round top, and on each side of the seat were armrests and two lions standing beside the armrests,
- 20 *And twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other upon the six steps: there was not the like made in any kingdom.* While twelve lions stood there, one on each end of a step on the six steps. Nothing like it was ever made in any kingdom.
- 21 *And all king Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were of pure gold; none were of silver: it was nothing accounted of in the days of Solomon.* All King Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold. All the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were of pure gold. None were of silver; silver was not considered as anything in the days of Solomon.
- 22 *For the king had at sea a navy of Tarshish with the navy of Hiram: once in three years came the navy of Tarshish, bringing gold, and silver, ivory, and apes, and peacocks.* For the king had a fleet of ships of Tarshish at sea with the fleet of Hiram. Once every three years the fleet of ships of Tarshish used to come bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks.
- 23 *So king Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth for riches and for wisdom.* Thus King Solomon excelled all the kings of the earth in riches and in wisdom.
- 24 *And all the earth sought to Solomon, to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart.* The whole earth sought the presence of Solomon to hear his wisdom, which God had put into his mind.
- 25 *And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and garments, and armour, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year.* Every one of them brought his present, articles of silver and gold, garments, myrrh, spices, horses, and mules, so much year by year.

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| <p>26 <i>And Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen: and he had a thousand and four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, whom he bestowed in the cities for chariots, and with the king at Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And the king made silver to be in Jerusalem as stones, and cedars made he to be as the sycamore trees that are in the vale, for abundance.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And Solomon had horses brought out of Egypt, and linen yarn: the king's merchants received the linen yarn at a price.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And a chariot came up and went out of Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and an horse for an hundred and fifty: and so for all the kings of the Hittites, and for the kings of Syria, did they bring them out by their means.</i></p> | <p>Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen. He had 1,400 chariots and 12,000 horsemen, whom he stationed in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem.</p> <p>The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stone. He made cedar as plentiful as the sycamore of the Shephelah.</p> <p>Solomon's import of horses was from Egypt and linen yarn, and the king's traders received the linen yarn at a price.</p> <p>A chariot could be imported from Egypt for 600 shekels of silver and a horse for 150, and so through the king's traders they were exported to all the kings of the Hittites and the kings of Syria.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Cross-References:

v1 — Matt 12:42; Luke 11:31; Gen 10:28; Ps 72:15; 2 Chr 9:1-12

v8 — Prov 8:34

v9 — Ps 72:2; 1 Kgs 5:7; 2 Sam 8:15

v10 — 1 Kgs 10:2

v11 — 1 Kgs 9:27-28

v17 — 1 Kgs 7:2

v18 — 1 Kgs 10:22; Ps 45:8

v22 — 1 Kgs 22:48

v23 — 1 Kgs 3:12-13

v24 — Jas 1:5; 1 Kgs 3:28; 1 Kgs 3:12

v26 — 2 Chr 9:25; 1 Kgs 4:26

v28 — Deut 17:16; 2 Chr 9:28; Isa 31:1-3

Chapter 11

Solomon loved many foreign women who turned his heart after other gods, and the LORD raised up adversaries against him: Hadad the Edomite, Rezon of Syria, and Jeroboam. God told Solomon the kingdom would be torn from his son, leaving only one tribe for David's sake.

- 1 *But king Solomon loved many strange women, together with the daughter of Pharaoh, women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Zidonians, and Hittites;* Now King Solomon loved many foreign women, along with the daughter of Pharaoh: Moabite, Ammonite, Edomite, Sidonian, and Hittite women,
- 2 *Of the nations concerning which the LORD said unto the children of Israel, Ye shall not go in to them, neither shall they come in unto you: for surely they will turn away your heart after their gods: Solomon clave unto these in love.* From the nations concerning which the LORD had said to the people of Israel, "You shall not enter into marriage with them, neither shall they with You, for surely they will turn away Your heart after their gods." Solomon clung to these in love.
- 3 *And he had seven hundred wives, princesses, and three hundred concubines: and his wives turned away his heart.* He had 700 wives, who were princesses, and 300 concubines. And his wives turned away His heart.
- 4 *For it came to pass, when Solomon was old, that his wives turned away his heart after other gods: and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as was the heart of David his father.* For when Solomon was old his wives turned away his heart after other gods. His heart was not wholly true to the LORD His God, as was the heart of David his father.

- 5 *For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Zidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.* For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.
- 6 *And Solomon did evil in the sight of the LORD, and went not fully after the LORD, as did David his father.* So Solomon did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and did not wholly follow the LORD, as David his father had done.
- 7 *Then did Solomon build an high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab, in the hill that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech, the abomination of the children of Ammon.* Then Solomon built a high place for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, and for Molech the abomination of the Ammonites, on the mountain east of Jerusalem.
- 8 *And likewise did he for all his strange wives, which burnt incense and sacrificed unto their gods.* So he did for all his foreign wives, who made offerings and sacrificed to their gods.
- 9 *And the LORD was angry with Solomon, because his heart was turned from the LORD God of Israel, which had appeared unto him twice,* The LORD was angry with Solomon, because his heart had turned away from the LORD, the God of Israel, who had appeared to Him twice
- 10 *And had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not go after other gods: but he kept not that which the LORD commanded.* Had commanded Him concerning this thing, that He should not go after other gods. But He did not keep what the LORD commanded.
- 11 *Wherefore the LORD said unto Solomon, Forasmuch as this is done of thee, and thou hast not kept my covenant and my statutes, which I have commanded thee, I will surely rend the kingdom from thee, and will give it to thy servant.* Therefore the LORD said to Solomon, "Since this has been your practice and you have not kept my covenant and my statutes that I have commanded you, I will surely tear the kingdom from you and will give it to your servant.
- 12 *Notwithstanding in thy days I will not do it for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son.* Yet for the sake of David your father I will not do it in your days. But I will tear it out of the hand of your son.

- 13 *Howbeit I will not rend away all the kingdom; but will give one tribe to thy son for David my servant's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake which I have chosen.* However, I will not tear away all the kingdom. But I will give one tribe to your son, for the sake of David my servant and for the sake of Jerusalem that I have chosen."
- 14 *And the LORD stirred up an adversary unto Solomon, Hadad the Edomite: he was of the king's seed in Edom.* The LORD raised up an adversary against Solomon, Hadad the Edomite. He was of the royal house in Edom.
- 15 *For it came to pass, when David was in Edom, and Joab the captain of the host was gone up to bury the slain, after he had smitten every male in Edom;* For when David was in Edom, and Joab the commander of the army went up to bury the slain, he struck down every male in Edom
- 16 *(For six months did Joab remain there with all Israel, until he had cut off every male in Edom:)* (for Joab and all Israel remained there six months, until he had cut off every male in Edom).
- 17 *That Hadad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants with him, to go into Egypt; Hadad being yet a little child.* But Hadad fled to Egypt, together with certain Edomites of his father's servants, Hadad still being a little child.
- 18 *And they arose out of Midian, and came to Paran: and they took men with them out of Paran, and they came to Egypt, unto Pharaoh king of Egypt; which gave him an house, and appointed him victuals, and gave him land.* They set out from Midian and came to Paran and took men with them from Paran and came to Egypt, to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave him a house and assigned him an allowance of food and gave him land.
- 19 *And Hadad found great favour in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him to wife the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen.* Hadad found great favor in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him in marriage the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen.

- 20 *And the sister of Tahpenes bare him Genubath his son, whom Tahpenes weaned in Pharaoh's house: and Genubath was in Pharaoh's household among the sons of Pharaoh.* The sister of Tahpenes bore him Genubath his son, whom Tahpenes weaned in Pharaoh's house. And Genubath was in Pharaoh's house among the sons of Pharaoh.
- 21 *And when Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab the captain of the host was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, Let me depart, that I may go to mine own country.* But when Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers and that Joab the commander of the army was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, "Let me depart, that I may go to my own country."
- 22 *Then Pharaoh said unto him, But what hast thou lacked with me, that, behold, thou seekest to go to thine own country? And he answered, Nothing: howbeit let me go in any wise.* But Pharaoh said to him, "What have you lacked with me that you are now seeking to go to your own country?" And he said to him, "Only let me go."
- 23 *And God stirred him up another adversary, Rezon the son of Eliadah, which fled from his lord Hadadezer king of Zobah:* God also raised up as an adversary to Him Rezon the son of Eliada, who had fled from His master Hadadezer king of Zobah.
- 24 *And he gathered men unto him, and became captain over a band, when David slew them of Zobah: and they went to Damascus, and dwelt therein, and reigned in Damascus.* He gathered men around him and became leader of a marauding band, after the killing by David. And they went to Damascus and lived there and made him king in Damascus.
- 25 *And he was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon, beside the mischief that Hadad did: and he abhorred Israel, and reigned over Syria.* He was an adversary of Israel all the days of Solomon, doing harm as Hadad did. And he loathed Israel and reigned over Syria.

- 26 *And Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephrathite of Zereda, Solomon's servant, whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow woman, even he lifted up his hand against the king.* Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephraimite of Zeredah, a servant of Solomon, whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow, also lifted up his hand against the king.
- 27 *And this was the cause that he lifted up his hand against the king: Solomon built Millo, and repaired the breaches of the city of David his father.* This was the reason why he lifted up his hand against the king. Solomon built the Millo, and closed up the breach of the city of David his father.
- 28 *And the man Jeroboam was a mighty man of valour: and Solomon seeing the young man that he was industrious, he made him ruler over all the charge of the house of Joseph.* The man Jeroboam was very able, and when Solomon saw that the young man was industrious he gave him charge over all the forced labor of the house of Joseph.
- 29 *And it came to pass at that time when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, that the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him in the way; and he had clad himself with a new garment; and they two were alone in the field:* At that time, when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him on the road. Now Ahijah had dressed himself in a new garment, and the two of them were alone in the open country.
- 30 *And Ahijah caught the new garment that was on him, and rent it in twelve pieces:* Then Ahijah laid hold of the new garment that was on him, and tore it into twelve pieces.
- 31 *And he said to Jeroboam, Take thee ten pieces: for thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon, and will give ten tribes to thee:* He said to Jeroboam, "Take for yourself ten pieces, for thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, 'See, I am about to tear the kingdom from the hand of Solomon and will give you ten tribes
- 32 *(But he shall have one tribe for my servant David's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel:)* (but he shall have one tribe, for the sake of my servant David and for the sake of Jerusalem, the city that I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel),

- 33 *Because that they have forsaken me, and have worshipped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Zidonians, Chemosh the god of the Moabites, and Milcom the god of the children of Ammon, and have not walked in my ways, to do that which is right in mine eyes, and to keep my statutes and my judgments, as did David his father.* Because they have abandoned me and worshiped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh the god of Moab, and Milcom the god of the Ammonites. They have not walked in my ways, doing what is right in my sight and keeping my statutes and my rules, as David his father did.
- 34 *Howbeit I will not take the whole kingdom out of his hand: but I will make him prince all the days of his life for David my servant's sake, whom I chose, because he kept my commandments and my statutes:* Nevertheless, I will not take the whole kingdom out of his hand. But I will make him ruler all the days of his life, for the sake of David my servant whom I chose, who kept my commandments and my statutes.
- 35 *But I will take the kingdom out of his son's hand, and will give it unto thee, even ten tribes.* But I will take the kingdom out of his son's hand and will give it to you, ten tribes.
- 36 *And unto his son will I give one tribe, that David my servant may have a light alway before me in Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen me to put my name there.* Yet to his son I will give one tribe, that David my servant may always have a lamp before me in Jerusalem, the city where I have chosen to put my name.
- 37 *And I will take thee, and thou shalt reign according to all that thy soul desireth, and shalt be king over Israel.* I will take you, and you shall reign over all that your soul desires, and you shall be king over Israel.
- 38 *And it shall be, if thou wilt hearken unto all that I command thee, and wilt walk in my ways, and do that is right in my sight, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as David my servant did; that I will be with thee, and build thee a sure house, as I built for David, and will give Israel unto thee.* If you will listen to all that I command you, and will walk in my ways, and do what is right in my eyes by keeping my statutes and my commandments, as David my servant did, I will be with you and will build you a sure house, as I built for David. I will give Israel to you.

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| 39 | <i>And I will for this afflict the seed of David, but not for ever.</i> | I will afflict the seed of David because of this, but not forever.' " |
| 40 | <i>Solomon sought therefore to kill Jeroboam. And Jeroboam arose, and fled into Egypt, unto Shishak king of Egypt, and was in Egypt until the death of Solomon.</i> | Solomon sought therefore to kill Jeroboam. But Jeroboam arose and fled into Egypt, to Shishak king of Egypt, and was in Egypt until the death of Solomon. |
| 41 | <i>And the rest of the acts of Solomon, and all that he did, and his wisdom, are they not written in the book of the acts of Solomon?</i> | Now the rest of the acts of Solomon. All that he did. His wisdom, are they not written in the Book of the Acts of Solomon? |
| 42 | <i>And the time that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel was forty years.</i> | The time that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel was forty years. |
| 43 | <i>And Solomon slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David his father: and Rehoboam his son reigned in his stead.</i> | Solomon slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David his father. And Rehoboam his son reigned in his place. |

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 17:17; Prov 6:24

v2 — Ex 34:16; Deut 7:3-4; Josh 23:12-13; 2 Cor 6:14-16; Num 25:1-3

- v4 — 1 Kgs 9:4; 1 Kgs 8:61
- v5 — 1 Kgs 11:7; Judg 2:13
- v9 — 1 Kgs 3:5; 1 Kgs 9:2
- v11 — 1 Kgs 12:15-16; 1 Kgs 11:31
- v13 — 1 Kgs 12:20; Deut 12:11; 1 Kgs 11:32
- v15 — 2 Sam 8:14; 1 Chr 18:12-13
- v19 — Gen 39:21; Acts 7:10
- v29 — 1 Kgs 12:15; 1 Kgs 14:2; 2 Chr 9:29
- v36 — 1 Kgs 15:4; 2 Kgs 8:19; 1 Kgs 11:13
- v38 — 2 Sam 7:11; Josh 1:5

Rehoboam of Judah — 931–913 BC

Jeroboam I of Israel — 930–910 BC

Chapter 12

Rehoboam rejected the elders' counsel and threatened harsher labor, causing the ten northern tribes to revolt under Jeroboam. Jeroboam set up golden calves at Bethel and Dan to keep the people from worshiping in Jerusalem.

- 1

And Rehoboam went to Shechem: for all Israel were come to Shechem to make him king.

Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Rehoboam** (reh-hoh-BOH-am) — "the people are enlarged" — Solomon's son and successor, whose arrogant refusal to lighten the people's burdens caused the kingdom to split. He ruled the southern kingdom of Judah (two tribes) for seventeen years.

- 2

And it came to pass, when Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who was yet in Egypt, heard of it, (for he was fled from the presence of king Solomon, and Jeroboam dwelt in Egypt;)

As soon as Jeroboam the son of Nebat heard of it (for he was still in Egypt, where he had fled from King Solomon), then Jeroboam returned from Egypt.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jeroboam** (jair-uh-BOH-am) — "the people contend" — Son of Nebat, an Ephraimite servant of Solomon to whom God promised ten tribes through the prophet Ahijah. He became the first king of the northern kingdom (Israel) but set up golden calves at Bethel and Dan, becoming the benchmark for all subsequent wicked kings: "the sins of Jeroboam."

- 3 *That they sent and called him. And Jeroboam and all the congregation of Israel came, and spake unto Rehoboam, saying,* They sent and called him, and Jeroboam and all the assembly of Israel came and said to Rehoboam,
- 4 *Thy father made our yoke grievous: now therefore make thou the grievous service of thy father, and his heavy yoke which he put upon us, lighter, and we will serve thee.* "Your father made our yoke heavy. Now therefore lighten the hard service of your father and his heavy yoke on us. We will serve you."
- 5 *And he said unto them, Depart yet for three days, then come again to me. And the people departed.* He said to them, "Go away for three days, then come again to me." So the people went away.
- 6 *And king Rehoboam consulted with the old men, that stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, and said, How do ye advise that I may answer this people?* Then King Rehoboam took counsel with the old men, who had stood before Solomon his father while he was yet alive, saying, "How do you advise me to answer this people?"
- 7 *And they spake unto him, saying, If thou wilt be a servant unto this people this day, and wilt serve them, and answer them, and speak good words to them, then they will be thy servants for ever.* They said to him, "If you will be a servant to this people today and serve them, and speak good words to them when you answer them, then they will be your servants forever."
- 8 *But he forsook the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, and consulted with the young men that were grown up with him, and which stood before him:* But he abandoned the counsel that the old men gave him and took counsel with the young men who had grown up with him and stood before him.
- 9 *And he said unto them, What counsel give ye that we may answer this people, who have spoken to me, saying, Make the yoke which thy father did put upon us lighter?* He said to them, "What do you advise that we answer this people who have said to me, 'Lighten the yoke that your father put on us?'"

- 10 *And the young men that were grown up with him spake unto him, saying, Thus shalt thou speak unto this people that spake unto thee, saying, Thy father made our yoke heavy, but make thou it lighter unto us; thus shalt thou say unto them, My little finger shall be thicker than my father's loins.* The young men who had grown up with him said to him, "Thus shall you speak to this people who said to you, 'Your father made our yoke heavy, but you lighten it for us,' thus shall you say to them, 'My little finger is thicker than my father's loins.
- 11 *And now whereas my father did lade you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke: my father hath chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.* Now, whereas my father laid on you a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke. My father disciplined you with whips. But I will discipline you with scorpions.' "
- 12 *So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king had appointed, saying, Come to me again the third day.* So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king had said, "Come to me again the third day."
- 13 *And the king answered the people roughly, and forsook the old men's counsel that they gave him;* The king answered the people harshly, and forsaking the counsel that the old men had given him,
- 14 *And spake to them after the counsel of the young men, saying, My father made your yoke heavy, and I will add to your yoke: my father also chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.* He spoke to them according to the counsel of the young men, saying, "My father made your yoke heavy. But I will add to your yoke. My father disciplined you with whips. But I will discipline you with scorpions."
- 15 *Wherefore the king hearkened not unto the people; for the cause was from the LORD, that he might perform his saying, which the LORD spake by Ahijah the Shilonite unto Jeroboam the son of Nebat.* So the king did not listen to the people, for it was a turn of affairs brought about by the LORD that he might fulfill his word, which the LORD spoke by Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat.

- 16 *So when all Israel saw that the king hearkened not unto them, the people answered the king, saying, What portion have we in David? neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: to your tents, O Israel: now see to thine own house, David. So Israel departed unto their tents.* When all Israel saw that the king did not listen to them, the people answered the king, "What portion do we have in David? We have no inheritance in the son of Jesse. To your tents, O Israel! Look now to your own house, David." So Israel went to their tents.
- 17 *But as for the children of Israel which dwelt in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them.* But Rehoboam reigned over the people of Israel who lived in the cities of Judah.
- 18 *Then king Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was over the tribute; and all Israel stoned him with stones, that he died. Therefore king Rehoboam made speed to get him up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem.* Then King Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was taskmaster over the forced labor. All Israel stoned him to death with stones. And King Rehoboam hurried to mount his chariot to flee to Jerusalem.
- 19 *So Israel rebelled against the house of David unto this day.* So Israel has been in rebellion against the house of David to this day.
- 20 *And it came to pass, when all Israel heard that Jeroboam was come again, that they sent and called him unto the congregation, and made him king over all Israel: there was none that followed the house of David, but the tribe of Judah only.* When all Israel heard that Jeroboam had returned, they sent and called him to the assembly and made him king over all Israel. There was none that followed the house of David but the tribe of Judah only.
- 21 *And when Rehoboam was come to Jerusalem, he assembled all the house of Judah, with the tribe of Benjamin, an hundred and fourscore thousand chosen men, which were warriors, to fight against the house of Israel, to bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam the son of Solomon.* When Rehoboam came to Jerusalem, he assembled all the house of Judah and the tribe of Benjamin, 180,000 chosen warriors, to fight against the house of Israel, to restore the kingdom to Rehoboam the son of Solomon.

- 22 *But the word of God came unto Shemaiah the man of God, saying,* But the word of God came to Shemaiah the man of God:
- 23 *Speak unto Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and unto all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the remnant of the people, saying,* "Say to Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the rest of the people,
- 24 *Thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren the children of Israel: return every man to his house; for this thing is from me. They hearkened therefore to the word of the LORD, and returned to depart, according to the word of the LORD.* "Thus says the LORD, You shall not go up or fight against Your relatives the people of Israel. Every man return to his home, for this thing is from me." So they listened to the word of the LORD and went home again, according to the word of the LORD.
- 25 *Then Jeroboam built Shechem in mount Ephraim, and dwelt therein; and went out from thence, and built Penuel.* Then Jeroboam built Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim and lived there. And he went out from there and built Penuel.
- 26 *And Jeroboam said in his heart, Now shall the kingdom return to the house of David:* Jeroboam said in his heart, "Now the kingdom will turn back to the house of David.
- 27 *If this people go up to do sacrifice in the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, then shall the heart of this people turn again unto their lord, even unto Rehoboam king of Judah, and they shall kill me, and go again to Rehoboam king of Judah.* If this people go up to offer sacrifices in the temple of the LORD at Jerusalem, then the heart of this people will turn again to their lord, to Rehoboam king of Judah. They will kill me and return to Rehoboam king of Judah."
- 28 *Whereupon the king took counsel, and made two calves of gold, and said unto them, It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem: behold thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.* So the king took counsel and made two calves of gold. And he said to the people, "You have gone up to Jerusalem long enough. See your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt."
- 29 *And he set the one in Bethel, and the other put he in Dan.* He set one in Bethel, and the other he put in Dan.

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| <p>30 <i>And this thing became a sin: for the people went to worship before the one, even unto Dan.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And he made an house of high places, and made priests of the lowest of the people, which were not of the sons of Levi.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And Jeroboam ordained a feast in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month, like unto the feast that is in Judah, and he offered upon the altar. So did he in Bethel, sacrificing unto the calves that he had made: and he placed in Bethel the priests of the high places which he had made.</i></p> <p>33 <i>So he offered upon the altar which he had made in Bethel the fifteenth day of the eighth month, even in the month which he had devised of his own heart; and ordained a feast unto the children of Israel: and he offered upon the altar, and burnt incense.</i></p> | <p>Then this thing became a sin, for the people went as far as Dan to be before one of them.</p> <p>He also made temples on high places and appointed priests from among all the people, who were not of the Levites.</p> <p>Jeroboam appointed a feast on the fifteenth day of the eighth month like the feast that was in Judah. He offered sacrifices on the altar. So he did in Bethel, sacrificing to the calves that he made. And he placed in Bethel the priests of the high places that he had made.</p> <p>He went up to the altar that he had made in Bethel on the fifteenth day in the eighth month, in the month that he had devised from his own heart. And he instituted a feast for the people of Israel and went up to the altar to make offerings.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Kgs 11:40

v4 — 1 Sam 8:11-18; 1 Kgs 4:7; Matt 11:29-30

v15 — Deut 2:30; 1 Kgs 12:24; Judg 14:4; 2 Chr 25:20; 1 Kgs 11:29-38

v17 — 1 Kgs 11:36; 1 Kgs 11:13

v18 — 1 Kgs 4:6

v20 — 1 Kgs 11:32; 1 Kgs 11:13

v25 — Judg 8:17

v28 — Ex 32:4; 2 Kgs 10:29; Ex 32:8; 2 Kgs 17:16

v30 — 2 Kgs 17:21; 1 Kgs 13:34

v31 — 2 Kgs 17:32; 2 Chr 13:9; 1 Kgs 13:32-33

v33 — 1 Kgs 13:1

Chapter 13

A man of God from Judah prophesied against Jeroboam's altar at Bethel, and the altar was torn apart as a sign. The prophet was deceived by an old prophet into disobedience and was killed by a lion on the road.

- 1 *And, behold, there came a man of God out of Judah by the word of the LORD unto Bethel: and Jeroboam stood by the altar to burn incense.* A man of God came out of Judah by the word of the LORD to Bethel. Jeroboam was standing by the altar to make offerings.
- 2 *And he cried against the altar in the word of the LORD, and said, O altar, altar, thus saith the LORD; Behold, a child shall be born unto the house of David, Josiah by name; and upon thee shall he offer the priests of the high places that burn incense upon thee, and men's bones shall be burnt upon thee.* The man cried against the altar by the word of the LORD and said, "O altar, altar, thus says the LORD: ' a son shall be born to the house of David, Josiah by name. He shall sacrifice on you the priests of the high places who make offerings on You, and human bones shall be burned on You.' "
- 3 *And he gave a sign the same day, saying, This is the sign which the LORD hath spoken; Behold, the altar shall be rent, and the ashes that are upon it shall be poured out.* He gave a sign the same day, saying, "This is the sign that the LORD has spoken: ' the altar shall be torn down, and the ashes that are on it shall be poured out.' "
- 4 *And it came to pass, when king Jeroboam heard the saying of the man of God, which had cried against the altar in Bethel, that he put forth his hand from the altar, saying, Lay hold on him. And his hand, which he put forth against him, dried up, so that he could not pull it in again to him.* When the king heard the saying of the man of God, which He cried against the altar at Bethel, Jeroboam stretched out his hand from the altar, saying, "Seize Him." And His hand, which He stretched out against Him, dried up, so that He could not draw it back to himself.

- 5 *The altar also was rent, and the ashes poured out from the altar, according to the sign which the man of God had given by the word of the LORD.* The altar also was torn down, and the ashes poured out from the altar, according to the sign that the man of God had given by the word of the LORD.
- 6 *And the king answered and said unto the man of God, Intreat now the face of the LORD thy God, and pray for me, that my hand may be restored me again. And the man of God besought the LORD, and the king's hand was restored him again, and became as it was before.* The king said to the man of God, "Entreat now the favor of the LORD your God, and pray for me, that my hand may be restored to me." And the man of God entreated the LORD, and the king's hand was restored to him and became as it was before.
- 7 *And the king said unto the man of God, Come home with me, and refresh thyself, and I will give thee a reward.* The king said to the man of God, "Come home with me, and refresh yourself. I will give you a reward."
- 8 *And the man of God said unto the king, If thou wilt give me half thine house, I will not go in with thee, neither will I eat bread nor drink water in this place:* The man of God said to the king, "If you give me half your house, I will not go in with you. And I will not eat bread or drink water in this place,
- 9 *For so was it charged me by the word of the LORD, saying, Eat no bread, nor drink water, nor turn again by the same way that thou camest.* For so was it commanded me by the word of the LORD, saying, 'You shall neither eat bread nor drink water nor return by the way that You came.' "
- 10 *So he went another way, and returned not by the way that he came to Bethel.* So He went another way and did not return by the way that He came to Bethel.
- 11 *Now there dwelt an old prophet in Bethel; and his sons came and told him all the works that the man of God had done that day in Bethel: the words which he had spoken unto the king, them they told also to their father.* Now there lived an old prophet in Bethel. And his sons came and told him all that the man of God had done that day in Bethel. They also told to their father the words that he had spoken to the king.

- 12 *And their father said unto them, What way went he? For his sons had seen what way the man of God went, which came from Judah.* Their father said to them, "Which way did he go?" And his sons showed him the way that the man of God Who came from Judah had gone.
- 13 *And he said unto his sons, Saddle me the ass. So they saddled him the ass: and he rode thereon,* He said to his sons, "Saddle the donkey for me." So they saddled the donkey for him and he mounted it.
- 14 *And went after the man of God, and found him sitting under an oak: and he said unto him, Art thou the man of God that camest from Judah? And he said, I am.* He went after the man of God and found Him sitting under an oak. And He said to Him, "Are you the man of God Who came from Judah?" And He said, "I am."
- 15 *Then he said unto him, Come home with me, and eat bread.* Then he said to him, "Come home with me and eat bread."
- 16 *And he said, I may not return with thee, nor go in with thee: neither will I eat bread nor drink water with thee in this place:* He said, "I may not return with you, or go in with you, neither will I eat bread nor drink water with you in this place,
- 17 *For it was said to me by the word of the LORD, Thou shalt eat no bread nor drink water there, nor turn again to go by the way that thou camest.* For it was said to me by the word of the LORD, 'You shall neither eat bread nor drink water there, nor return by the way that You came.' "
- 18 *He said unto him, I am a prophet also as thou art; and an angel spake unto me by the word of the LORD, saying, Bring him back with thee into thine house, that he may eat bread and drink water. But he lied unto him.* He said to Him, "I also am a prophet as You are, and an angel spoke to me by the word of the LORD, saying, 'Bring Him back with You into Your house that He may eat bread and drink water.' " But He lied to Him.
- 19 *So he went back with him, and did eat bread in his house, and drank water.* So He went back with Him and ate bread in His house and drank water.
- 20 *And it came to pass, as they sat at the table, that the word of the LORD came unto the prophet that brought him back:* As they sat at the table, the word of the LORD came to the prophet who had brought him back.

- 21 *And he cried unto the man of God that came from Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Forasmuch as thou hast disobeyed the mouth of the LORD, and hast not kept the commandment which the LORD thy God commanded thee,* He cried to the man of God Who came from Judah, "Thus says the LORD, 'Because you have disobeyed the word of the LORD and have not kept the command that the LORD your God commanded you,
- 22 *But camest back, and hast eaten bread and drunk water in the place, of the which the LORD did say to thee, Eat no bread, and drink no water; thy carcase shall not come unto the sepulchre of thy fathers.* But have come back and have eaten bread and drunk water in the place of which He said to You, "Eat no bread and drink no water," your body shall not come to the tomb of Your fathers.' "
- 23 *And it came to pass, after he had eaten bread, and after he had drunk, that he saddled for him the ass, to wit, for the prophet whom he had brought back.* After he had eaten bread and drunk, he saddled the donkey for the prophet whom he had brought back.
- 24 *And when he was gone, a lion met him by the way, and slew him: and his carcase was cast in the way, and the ass stood by it, the lion also stood by the carcase.* As he went away a lion met him on the road and killed him. And his body was thrown in the road, and the donkey stood beside it; the lion also stood beside the body.
- 25 *And, behold, men passed by, and saw the carcase cast in the way, and the lion standing by the carcase: and they came and told it in the city where the old prophet dwelt.* People passed by and saw the body thrown in the road and the lion standing by the body. And they came and told it in the city where the old prophet lived.

- 26 *And when the prophet that brought him back from the way heard thereof, he said, It is the man of God, who was disobedient unto the word of the LORD: therefore the LORD hath delivered him unto the lion, which hath torn him, and slain him, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake unto him.* When the prophet who had brought him back from the way heard of it, He said, "It is the man of God Who disobeyed the word of the LORD; therefore the LORD has given Him to the lion, which has torn Him and killed Him, according to the word that the LORD spoke to Him."
- 27 *And he spake to his sons, saying, Saddle me the ass. And they saddled him.* He said to His sons, "Saddle the donkey for me." And they saddled it.
- 28 *And he went and found his carcase cast in the way, and the ass and the lion standing by the carcase: the lion had not eaten the carcase, nor torn the ass.* He went and found His body thrown in the road, and the donkey and the lion standing beside the body. The lion had not eaten the body or torn the donkey.
- 29 *And the prophet took up the carcase of the man of God, and laid it upon the ass, and brought it back: and the old prophet came to the city, to mourn and to bury him.* The prophet took up the body of the man of God and laid it on the donkey and brought it back to the city to mourn and to bury Him.
- 30 *And he laid his carcase in his own grave; and they mourned over him, saying, Alas, my brother!* He laid the body in his own grave. And they mourned over him, saying, "Alas, my brother!"
- 31 *And it came to pass, after he had buried him, that he spake to his sons, saying, When I am dead, then bury me in the sepulchre wherein the man of God is buried; lay my bones beside his bones:* After he had buried him, he said to his sons, "When I die, bury me in the grave in which the man of God is buried; lay my bones beside His bones.

- 32 *For the saying which he cried by the word of the LORD against the altar in Bethel, and against all the houses of the high places which are in the cities of Samaria, shall surely come to pass.* For the saying that He cried by the word of the LORD against the altar in Bethel and against all the houses of the high places that are in the cities of Samaria shall surely come to pass."
- 33 *After this thing Jeroboam returned not from his evil way, but made again of the lowest of the people priests of the high places: whosoever would, he consecrated him, and he became one of the priests of the high places.* After this thing Jeroboam did not turn from his evil way, but made priests for the high places again from among all the people. Any who would, he ordained as priests of the high places.
- 34 *And this thing became sin unto the house of Jeroboam, even to cut it off, and to destroy it from off the face of the earth.* This thing became sin to the house of Jeroboam, so as to cut it off and to destroy it from the face of the earth.

Words in this chapter:

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Kgs 23:17; 1 Kgs 12:32-33; 1 Thess 4:15; Jer 25:3
v6 — Ex 10:17; Ex 8:8; Ex 9:28; Acts 8:24; Luke 6:27-28
v7 — 2 Kgs 5:15
v8 — Num 24:13; Num 22:18
v18 — 1 John 4:1; Matt 7:15
v24 — 1 Kgs 20:36
v30 — Jer 22:18
v32 — 1 Kgs 16:24; 1 Kgs 13:2
v34 — 1 Kgs 12:30; 1 Kgs 15:29-30; 1 Kgs 14:10

Chapter 14

Jeroboam's son fell ill, and the prophet Ahijah told Jeroboam's wife that the child would die and the house of Jeroboam would be cut off. Rehoboam reigned in Judah and did evil; Shishak

king of Egypt plundered the temple treasures.

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| 1 <i>At that time Abijah the son of Jeroboam fell sick.</i> | At that time Abijah the son of Jeroboam fell sick. |
| 2 <i>And Jeroboam said to his wife, Arise, I pray thee, and disguise thyself, that thou be not known to be the wife of Jeroboam; and get thee to Shiloh: behold, there is Ahijah the prophet, which told me that I should be king over this people.</i> | Jeroboam said to his wife, "Arise, and disguise yourself, that it not be known that you are the wife of Jeroboam, and go to Shiloh. Ahijah the prophet is there, who said of me that I should be king over this people. |
| 3 <i>And take with thee ten loaves, and cracknels, and a cruse of honey, and go to him: he shall tell thee what shall become of the child.</i> | Take with you ten loaves, some cakes, and a jar of honey, and go to him. He will tell you what shall happen to the child." |
| 4 <i>And Jeroboam's wife did so, and arose, and went to Shiloh, and came to the house of Ahijah. But Ahijah could not see; for his eyes were set by reason of his age.</i> | Jeroboam's wife did so. She arose and went to Shiloh and came to the house of Ahijah. Now Ahijah could not see, for his eyes were dim because of his age. |
| 5 <i>And the LORD said unto Ahijah, Behold, the wife of Jeroboam cometh to ask a thing of thee for her son; for he is sick: thus and thus shalt thou say unto her: for it shall be, when she cometh in, that she shall feign herself to be another woman.</i> | The LORD said to Ahijah, " the wife of Jeroboam is coming to inquire of you concerning her son, for He is sick. Thus and so shall You say to her." When she came, she pretended to be another woman. |
| 6 <i>And it was so, when Ahijah heard the sound of her feet, as she came in at the door, that he said, Come in, thou wife of Jeroboam; why feignest thou thyself to be another? for I am sent to thee with heavy tidings.</i> | But when Ahijah heard the sound of her feet, as she came in at the door, he said, "Come in, wife of Jeroboam. Why do you pretend to be another? For I am charged with harsh news for you. |

- 7 *Go, tell Jeroboam, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Forasmuch as I exalted thee from among the people, and made thee prince over my people Israel,* Go, tell Jeroboam, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: "Because I exalted You from among the people and made you leader over my people Israel
- 8 *And rent the kingdom away from the house of David, and gave it thee: and yet thou hast not been as my servant David, who kept my commandments, and who followed me with all his heart, to do that only which was right in mine eyes;* Tore the kingdom away from the house of David and gave it to you, and yet you have not been like my servant David, who kept my commandments and followed me with all his heart, doing only that which was right in my eyes,
- 9 *But hast done evil above all that were before thee: for thou hast gone and made thee other gods, and molten images, to provoke me to anger, and hast cast me behind thy back:* But you have done evil above all who were before you and have gone and made for yourself other gods and metal images, provoking me to anger, and have cast me behind your back—
- 10 *Therefore, behold, I will bring evil upon the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off from Jeroboam him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel, and will take away the remnant of the house of Jeroboam, as a man taketh away dung, till it be all gone.* Therefore I will bring harm upon the house of Jeroboam and will cut off from Jeroboam him that pisseth against the wall, both bond and free in Israel, and will burn up the house of Jeroboam, as a man burns up dung until it is all gone.
- 11 *Him that dieth of Jeroboam in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat: for the LORD hath spoken it.* Anyone belonging to Jeroboam who dies in the city the dogs shall eat, and anyone who dies in the open country the birds of the heavens shall eat, for the LORD has spoken it."
- 12 *Arise thou therefore, get thee to thine own house: and when thy feet enter into the city, the child shall die.* Arise therefore, go to Your house. When Your feet enter the city, the child shall die.

- 13 *And all Israel shall mourn for him, and bury him: for he only of Jeroboam shall come to the grave, because in him there is found some good thing toward the LORD God of Israel in the house of Jeroboam.* All Israel shall mourn for Him and bury Him, for He only of Jeroboam shall come to the grave, because in him there is found something pleasing to the LORD, the God of Israel, in the house of Jeroboam.
- 14 *Moreover the LORD shall raise him up a king over Israel, who shall cut off the house of Jeroboam that day: but what? even now.* Moreover, the LORD will raise up for Himself a king over Israel who shall cut off the house of Jeroboam today. And henceforth,
- 15 *For the LORD shall smite Israel, as a reed is shaken in the water, and he shall root up Israel out of this good land, which he gave to their fathers, and shall scatter them beyond the river, because they have made their groves, provoking the LORD to anger.* The LORD will strike Israel as a reed is shaken in the water, and root up Israel out of this good land that He gave to their fathers and scatter them beyond the river, because they have made their groves, provoking the LORD to anger.
- 16 *And he shall give Israel up because of the sins of Jeroboam, who did sin, and who made Israel to sin.* He will give Israel up because of the sins of Jeroboam, which he sinned and made Israel to sin."
- 17 *And Jeroboam's wife arose, and departed, and came to Tirzah: and when she came to the threshold of the door, the child died;* Then Jeroboam's wife arose and departed and came to Tirzah. And as she came to the threshold of the house, the child died.
- 18 *And they buried him; and all Israel mourned for him, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by the hand of his servant Ahijah the prophet.* They buried Him. All Israel mourned for Him, according to the word of the LORD, which He spoke by His servant Ahijah the prophet.
- 19 *And the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he warred, and how he reigned, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he warred and how he reigned, they are written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

- 20 *And the days which Jeroboam reigned were two and twenty years: and he slept with his fathers, and Nadab his son reigned in his stead.* The time that Jeroboam reigned was twenty-two years. And he slept with his fathers, and Nadab his son reigned in his place.
- 21 *And Rehoboam the son of Solomon reigned in Judah. Rehoboam was forty and one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD did choose out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess.* Now Rehoboam the son of Solomon reigned in Judah. Rehoboam was forty-one years old when he began to reign. He reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city that the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, to put His name there. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite.
- 22 *And Judah did evil in the sight of the LORD, and they provoked him to jealousy with their sins which they had committed, above all that their fathers had done.* Judah did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. They provoked Him to jealousy with their sins that they committed, more than all that their fathers had done.
- 23 *For they also built them high places, and images, and groves, on every high hill, and under every green tree.* For they also built for themselves high places and images and groves on every high hill and under every green tree,
- 24 *And there were also sodomites in the land: and they did according to all the abominations of the nations which the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.* There were also sodomites in the land. They did according to all the abominations of the nations that the LORD drove out before the people of Israel.
- 25 *And it came to pass in the fifth year of king Rehoboam, that Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem:* In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem.
- 26 *And he took away the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house; he even took away all: and he took away all the shields of gold which Solomon had made.* He took away the treasures of the house of the LORD and the treasures of the king's house. He took away everything. He also took away all the shields of gold that Solomon had made,

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| 27 | <i>And king Rehoboam made in their stead brasen shields, and committed them unto the hands of the chief of the guard, which kept the door of the king's house.</i> | King Rehoboam made in their place shields of bronze, and committed them to the hands of the officers of the guard, who kept the door of the king's house. |
| 28 | <i>And it was so, when the king went into the house of the LORD, that the guard bare them, and brought them back into the guard chamber.</i> | As often as the king went into the house of the LORD, the guard carried them and brought them back to the guardroom. |
| 29 | <i>Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i> | Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? |
| 30 | <i>And there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all their days.</i> | There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually. |
| 31 | <i>And Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess. And Abijam his son reigned in his stead.</i> | Rehoboam slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite. And Abijam his son reigned in his place. |

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 Kgs 11:29-38; 1 Sam 28:8; 2 Sam 14:2
v8 — 1 Kgs 15:5
v9 — Neh 9:26; Ps 50:17; Ezek 23:35; 2 Chr 11:15; 1 Kgs 12:28
v10 — Deut 32:36; 1 Kgs 21:21; 2 Kgs 14:26
v11 — 1 Kgs 16:4
v13 — 2 Chr 19:3
v15 — Ps 52:5; Josh 23:15-16
v16 — 1 Kgs 13:34; 1 Kgs 15:30; 1 Kgs 15:34; 1 Kgs 16:2

- v21 — 2 Chr 12:13
- v22 — 1 Cor 10:22; 2 Chr 12:1; Ps 78:58
- v23 — Deut 12:2; Isa 57:5
- v24 — Deut 23:17; 1 Cor 6:9; 1 Kgs 15:12; 2 Kgs 23:7

Abijah of Judah — 913–911 BC
Asa of Judah — 911–870 BC
Nadab of Israel — 910–909 BC
Baasha of Israel — 909–886 BC

Chapter 15

Abijam reigned over Judah and walked in his father's sins, but Asa his son did right, removing idols and deposing his grandmother Maacah. In Israel, Nadab son of Jeroboam was assassinated by Baasha, who continued in Jeroboam's sin.

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| 1 | <i>Now in the eighteenth year of king Jeroboam the son of Nebat reigned Abijam over Judah.</i> | Now in the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam the son of Nebat, Abijam began to reign over Judah. |
| 2 | <i>Three years reigned he in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom.</i> | He reigned for three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom. |
| 3 | <i>And he walked in all the sins of his father, which he had done before him: and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as the heart of David his father.</i> | He walked in all the sins that His father did before Him. His heart was not wholly true to the LORD His God, as the heart of David his father. |
| 4 | <i>Nevertheless for David's sake did the LORD his God give him a lamp in Jerusalem, to set up his son after him, and to establish Jerusalem:</i> | Nevertheless, for David's sake the LORD His God gave Him a lamp in Jerusalem, setting up His son after Him, and establishing Jerusalem, |
| 5 | <i>Because David did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD, and turned not aside from any thing that he commanded him all the days of his life, save only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.</i> | Because David did what was right in the eyes of the LORD and did not turn aside from anything that He commanded Him all the days of His life, except in the matter of Uriah the Hittite. |

- 6 *And there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of his life.* Now there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of his life.
- 7 *Now the rest of the acts of Abijam, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? And there was war between Abijam and Jeroboam.* The rest of the acts of Abijam and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? And there was war between Abijam and Jeroboam.
- 8 *And Abijam slept with his fathers; and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa his son reigned in his stead.* Abijam slept with his fathers. They buried him in the city of David. And Asa his son reigned in his place.
- 9 *And in the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel reigned Asa over Judah.* In the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa began to reign over Judah,
- 10 *And forty and one years reigned he in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom.* He reigned forty-one years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom.
- 11 *And Asa did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD, as did David his father.* Asa did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, as David his father had done.
- 12 *And he took away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols that his fathers had made.* He put away the sodomites out of the land and removed all the idols that His fathers had made.
- 13 *And also Maachah his mother, even her he removed from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove; and Asa destroyed her idol, and burnt it by the brook Kidron.* He also removed Maacah his mother from being queen mother because she had made an idol in a grove. And Asa destroyed her idol and burned it at the brook Kidron.
- 14 *But the high places were not removed: nevertheless Asa's heart was perfect with the LORD all his days.* But the high places were not taken away. Nevertheless, the heart of Asa was wholly true to the LORD all His days.

- 15 *And he brought in the things which his father had dedicated, and the things which himself had dedicated, into the house of the LORD, silver, and gold, and vessels.* He brought into the house of the LORD the sacred gifts of His father and His own sacred gifts, silver, and gold, and vessels.
- 16 *And there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.* There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.
- 17 *And Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not suffer any to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.* Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah and built Ramah, that he might permit no one to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.
- 18 *Then Asa took all the silver and the gold that were left in the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house, and delivered them into the hand of his servants: and king Asa sent them to Benhadad, the son of Tabrimon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, that dwelt at Damascus, saying,* Then Asa took all the silver and the gold that were left in the treasures of the house of the LORD and the treasures of the king's house and gave them into the hands of his servants. And King Asa sent them to Ben-hadad the son of Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, who lived in Damascus, saying,
- 19 *There is a league between me and thee, and between my father and thy father: behold, I have sent unto thee a present of silver and gold; come and break thy league with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me.* "Let there be a covenant between me and You, as there was between my father and Your father. I am sending to You a present of silver and gold. Go, break Your covenant with Baasha king of Israel, that He may withdraw from me."
- 20 *And Benhadad hearkened unto king Asa, and sent the captains of the hosts which he had against the cities of Israel, and smote Ijon, and Dan, and Abelbethmaachah, and all Cinneroth, with all the land of Naphtali.* Ben-hadad listened to King Asa and sent the commanders of his armies against the cities of Israel and struck Ijon, Dan, Abel-beth-maacah. All Chinneroth, with all the land of Naphtali.

- 21 *And it came to pass, when Baasha heard thereof, that he left off building of Ramah, and dwelt in Tirzah.* When Baasha heard of it, he stopped building Ramah and lived in Tirzah.
- 22 *Then king Asa made a proclamation throughout all Judah; none was exempted: and they took away the stones of Ramah, and the timber thereof, wherewith Baasha had builded; and king Asa built with them Geba of Benjamin, and Mizpah.* Then King Asa made a proclamation to all Judah, none was exempt. They carried away the stones of Ramah and its timber, with which Baasha had been building, and with them King Asa built Geba of Benjamin and Mizpah.
- 23 *The rest of all the acts of Asa, and all his might, and all that he did, and the cities which he built, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? Nevertheless in the time of his old age he was diseased in his feet.* Now the rest of all the acts of Asa, all his might. All that he did, and the cities that he built, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? But in his old age he was diseased in his feet.
- 24 *And Asa slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his stead.* Asa slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father, and Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his place.
- 25 *And Nadab the son of Jeroboam began to reign over Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned over Israel two years.* Nadab the son of Jeroboam began to reign over Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah. He reigned over Israel two years.
- 26 *And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of his father, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the way of His father, and in His sin which He made Israel to sin.
- 27 *And Baasha the son of Ahijah, of the house of Issachar, conspired against him; and Baasha smote him at Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines; for Nadab and all Israel laid siege to Gibbethon.* Baasha the son of Ahijah, of the house of Issachar, conspired against Him. And Baasha struck Him down at Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines, for Nadab and all Israel were laying siege to Gibbethon.

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| <p>28 <i>Even in the third year of Asa king of Judah did Baasha slay him, and reigned in his stead.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And it came to pass, when he reigned, that he smote all the house of Jeroboam; he left not to Jeroboam any that breathed, until he had destroyed him, according unto the saying of the LORD, which he spake by his servant Ahijah the Shilonite:</i></p> <p>30 <i>Because of the sins of Jeroboam which he sinned, and which he made Israel sin, by his provocation wherewith he provoked the LORD God of Israel to anger.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Nadab, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?</i></p> <p>32 <i>And there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.</i></p> <p>33 <i>In the third year of Asa king of Judah began Baasha the son of Ahijah to reign over all Israel in Tirzah, twenty and four years.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin.</i></p> | <p>So Baasha killed him in the third year of Asa king of Judah and reigned in his place.</p> <p>As soon as He was king, He killed all the house of Jeroboam. He left to the house of Jeroboam not one that breathed, until he had destroyed it, according to the word of the LORD that He spoke by His servant Ahijah the Shilonite.</p> <p>It was for the sins of Jeroboam that he sinned and that he made Israel to sin, and because of the anger to which He provoked the LORD, the God of Israel.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Nadab and all that He did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?</p> <p>There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.</p> <p>In the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasha the son of Ahijah began to reign over all Israel at Tirzah. He reigned twenty-four years.</p> <p>He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the way of Jeroboam and in his sin which he made Israel to sin.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Cross-References:

v3 — 1 Kgs 11:4
v4 — 1 Kgs 11:36; 2 Chr 21:7
v5 — 1 Kgs 14:8; 2 Sam 11:15-17
v6 — 1 Kgs 14:30
v11 — 2 Chr 14:2
v12 — 1 Kgs 22:46
v13 — Ex 32:20
v14 — 1 Kgs 22:43; 1 Kgs 8:61; 1 Kgs 15:3
v15 — 1 Kgs 7:51
v18 — 2 Kgs 12:18; 1 Kgs 14:26
v20 — 2 Kgs 15:29; Judg 18:29
v27 — 1 Kgs 14:14; Josh 21:23; Josh 19:44
Elah of Israel — 886–885 BC
Zimri of Israel — 885 BC (seven days)
Omri of Israel — 885–874 BC
Ahab of Israel — 874–853 BC

Chapter 16

Baasha's house was condemned by the prophet Jehu, and his son Elah was assassinated by Zimri, who reigned only seven days before Omri took power. Omri built Samaria, and his son Ahab married Jezebel and served Baal, doing more evil than all the kings before him.

1	<i>Then the word of the LORD came to Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha, saying,</i>	The word of the LORD came to Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha, saying,
2	<i>Forasmuch as I exalted thee out of the dust, and made thee prince over my people Israel; and thou hast walked in the way of Jeroboam, and hast made my people Israel to sin, to provoke me to anger with their sins;</i>	"Since I exalted you out of the dust and made you leader over my people Israel, and you have walked in the way of Jeroboam and have made my people Israel to sin, provoking me to anger with their sins,
3	<i>Behold, I will take away the posterity of Baasha, and the posterity of his house; and will make thy house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat.</i>	I will utterly sweep away Baasha and his house. I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat.

- 4 *Him that dieth of Baasha in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth of his in the fields shall the fowls of the air eat.* Anyone belonging to Baasha who dies in the city the dogs shall eat, and anyone of his who dies in the field the birds of the heavens shall eat."
- 5 *Now the rest of the acts of Baasha, and what he did, and his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Baasha and what he did. His might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 6 *So Baasha slept with his fathers, and was buried in Tirzah: and Elah his son reigned in his stead.* Baasha slept with his fathers and was buried at Tirzah, and Elah his son reigned in his place.
- 7 *And also by the hand of the prophet Jehu the son of Hanani came the word of the LORD against Baasha, and against his house, even for all the evil that he did in the sight of the LORD, in provoking him to anger with the work of his hands, in being like the house of Jeroboam; and because he killed him.* Moreover, the word of the LORD came by the prophet Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha and his house, both because of all the evil that He did in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger with the work of His hands, in being like the house of Jeroboam, and also because he destroyed it.
- 8 *In the twenty and sixth year of Asa king of Judah began Elah the son of Baasha to reign over Israel in Tirzah, two years.* In the twenty-sixth year of Asa king of Judah, Elah the son of Baasha began to reign over Israel in Tirzah. He reigned two years.
- 9 *And his servant Zimri, captain of half his chariots, conspired against him, as he was in Tirzah, drinking himself drunk in the house of Arza steward of his house in Tirzah.* But his servant Zimri, commander of half his chariots, conspired against him. When he was at Tirzah, drinking himself drunk in the house of Arza, who was over the household in Tirzah,
- 10 *And Zimri went in and smote him, and killed him, in the twenty and seventh year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned in his stead.* Zimri came in and struck him down and killed him, in the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned in his place.

- 11 *And it came to pass, when he began to reign, as soon as he sat on his throne, that he slew all the house of Baasha: he left him not one that pisseth against a wall, neither of his kinsfolks, nor of his friends.* When he began to reign, as soon as he had seated himself on his throne, he struck down all the house of Baasha. He did not leave him one that pisseth against a wall, neither of his kinsmen nor of his friends.
- 12 *Thus did Zimri destroy all the house of Baasha, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake against Baasha by Jehu the prophet,* Thus Zimri destroyed all the house of Baasha, according to the word of the LORD, which He spoke against Baasha by Jehu the prophet,
- 13 *For all the sins of Baasha, and the sins of Elah his son, by which they sinned, and by which they made Israel to sin, in provoking the LORD God of Israel to anger with their vanities.* For all the sins of Baasha and the sins of Elah His son, which they sinned and which they made Israel to sin, provoking the LORD God of Israel to anger with their idols.
- 14 *Now the rest of the acts of Elah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Elah and all that He did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 15 *In the twenty and seventh year of Asa king of Judah did Zimri reign seven days in Tirzah. And the people were encamped against Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines.* In the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah, Zimri reigned seven days in Tirzah. Now the troops were encamped against Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines,
- 16 *And the people that were encamped heard say, Zimri hath conspired, and hath also slain the king: wherefore all Israel made Omri, the captain of the host, king over Israel that day in the camp.* The troops who were encamped heard it said, "Zimri has conspired. He has also struck down the king." Therefore all Israel made Omri, the commander of the army, king over Israel that day in the camp.
- 17 *And Omri went up from Gibbethon, and all Israel with him, and they besieged Tirzah.* So Omri went up from Gibbethon. All Israel with him. They besieged Tirzah.

- 18 *And it came to pass, when Zimri saw that the city was taken, that he went into the palace of the king's house, and burnt the king's house over him with fire, and died.* When Zimri saw that the city was taken, he went into the citadel of the king's house and burned the king's house over him with fire and died,
- 19 *For his sins which he sinned in doing evil in the sight of the LORD, in walking in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin which he did, to make Israel to sin.* Because of His sins that He committed, doing evil in the sight of the LORD, walking in the way of Jeroboam, and for his sin which he committed, making Israel to sin.
- 20 *Now the rest of the acts of Zimri, and his treason that he wrought, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Zimri, and the conspiracy that He made, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 21 *Then were the people of Israel divided into two parts: half of the people followed Tibni the son of Ginath, to make him king; and half followed Omri.* Then the people of Israel were divided into two parts. Half of the people followed Tibni the son of Ginath, to make him king, and half followed Omri.
- 22 *But the people that followed Omri prevailed against the people that followed Tibni the son of Ginath: so Tibni died, and Omri reigned.* But the people who followed Omri overcame the people who followed Tibni the son of Ginath. So Tibni died, and Omri became king.
- 23 *In the thirty and first year of Asa king of Judah began Omri to reign over Israel, twelve years: six years reigned he in Tirzah.* In the thirty-first year of Asa king of Judah, Omri began to reign over Israel. He reigned for twelve years; six years he reigned at Tirzah.
- 24 *And he bought the hill Samaria of Shemer for two talents of silver, and built on the hill, and called the name of the city which he built, after the name of Shemer, owner of the hill, Samaria.* He bought the hill of Samaria from Shemer for two talents of silver. He fortified the hill and called the name of the city that he built Samaria, after the name of Shemer, the owner of the hill.

- 25 *But Omri wrought evil in the eyes of the LORD, and did worse than all that were before him.* Omri did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, and did more evil than all who were before Him.
- 26 *For he walked in all the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin, to provoke the LORD God of Israel to anger with their vanities.* For He walked in all the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and in the sins that he made Israel to sin, provoking the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger by their idols.
- 27 *Now the rest of the acts of Omri which he did, and his might that he shewed, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Omri that he did, and the might that he showed, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 28 *So Omri slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria: and Ahab his son reigned in his stead.* Omri slept with his fathers and was buried in Samaria, and Ahab his son reigned in his place.
- 29 *And in the thirty and eighth year of Asa king of Judah began Ahab the son of Omri to reign over Israel: and Ahab the son of Omri reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty and two years.* In the thirty-eighth year of Asa king of Judah, Ahab the son of Omri began to reign over Israel, and Ahab the son of Omri reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty-two years.
- 30 *And Ahab the son of Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD above all that were before him.* Ahab the son of Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD, more than all who were before Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ahab** (AY-hab) — "father's brother" — Son of Omri, king of Israel for twenty-two years, who did more evil than all the kings before him. He married Jezebel, introduced Baal worship into Israel, and murdered Naboth for his vineyard. He died by a random arrow at the battle of Ramoth-gilead.

- 31 *And it came to pass, as if it had been a light thing for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, that he took to wife Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Zidonians, and went and served Baal, and worshipped him.* As if it had been a light thing for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, he took for his wife Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and went and served Baal and worshiped him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jezebel** (JEZ-eh-bel) — "Where is the Prince?" (Baal title) — Daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians and wife of Ahab. She imported Baal worship into Israel, slaughtered the LORD's prophets, orchestrated Naboth's murder, and threatened Elijah's life. She was thrown from a window and eaten by dogs, as Elijah had prophesied.

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| 32 | <i>And he reared up an altar for Baal in the house of Baal, which he had built in Samaria.</i> | He erected an altar for Baal in the house of Baal, which He built in Samaria. |
| 33 | <i>And Ahab made a grove; and Ahab did more to provoke the LORD God of Israel to anger than all the kings of Israel that were before him.</i> | Ahab made a grove. Ahab did more to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger than all the kings of Israel who were before Him. |
| 34 | <i>In his days did Hiel the Bethelite build Jericho: he laid the foundation thereof in Abiram his firstborn, and set up the gates thereof in his youngest son Segub, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by Joshua the son of Nun.</i> | In His days Hiel of Bethel built Jericho. He laid its foundation at the cost of Abiram His firstborn, and set up its gates at the cost of His youngest son Segub, according to the word of the LORD, which He spoke by Joshua the son of Nun. |

Words in this chapter:

Ahab (AY-hab) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Jezebel (JEZ-eh-bel) — Ahab's Phoenician queen — aggressively promoted Baal worship and persecuted the prophets of God; killed Naboth to take his vineyard; eaten by dogs as prophesied.

Joshua (JOSH-oo-ah) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Jericho (JEHR-ih-ko) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Chr 19:2; 2 Chr 20:34
- v2 — 1 Kgs 15:34; 1 Kgs 14:7
- v3 — 1 Kgs 14:10
- v4 — 1 Kgs 14:11
- v6 — 1 Kgs 14:17
- v13 — Deut 32:21

- v15 — 1 Kgs 15:27
- v24 — 1 Kgs 13:32
- v25 — Mic 6:16
- v30 — 1 Kgs 16:25
- v31 — 2 Kgs 17:16; 2 Kgs 10:18
- v34 — Josh 6:26

Chapter 17

Elijah the prophet declared a drought on Israel, and the LORD sent him to the brook Cherith where ravens fed him. When the brook dried up, God sent him to a widow at Zarephath whose flour and oil did not run out, and Elijah raised her dead son to life.

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| 1 <i>And Elijah the Tishbite, who was of the inhabitants of Gilead, said unto Ahab, As the LORD God of Israel liveth, before whom I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to my word.</i> | Now Elijah the Tishbite, of Tishbe in Gilead, said to Ahab, "As the LORD, the God of Israel, lives, before whom I stand, there shall be neither dew nor rain these years, except by my word." |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elijah** (ee-LY-jah) — "my God is the LORD" — *The most dramatic prophet in the OT, who appeared without preamble to confront Ahab and Jezebel. He called down fire from heaven on Mount Carmel, was fed by ravens and angels, and was taken to heaven in a whirlwind without dying. He appeared with Moses at Christ's transfiguration.*

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| 2 <i>And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to Him: |
| 3 <i>Get thee hence, and turn thee eastward, and hide thyself by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.</i> | "Depart from here and turn eastward and hide Yourself by the brook Cherith, which is east of the Jordan. |
| 4 <i>And it shall be, that thou shalt drink of the brook; and I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there.</i> | You shall drink from the brook. I have commanded the ravens to feed You there." |
| 5 <i>So he went and did according unto the word of the LORD: for he went and dwelt by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.</i> | So He went and did according to the word of the LORD. He went and lived by the brook Cherith that is east of the Jordan. |

- 6 *And the ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening; and he drank of the brook.* The ravens brought Him bread and meat in the morning, and bread and meat in the evening. He drank from the brook.
- 7 *And it came to pass after a while, that the brook dried up, because there had been no rain in the land.* After a while the brook dried up, because there was no rain in the land.
- 8 *And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Him,
- 9 *Arise, get thee to Zarephath, which belongeth to Zidon, and dwell there: behold, I have commanded a widow woman there to sustain thee.* "Arise, go to Zarephath, which belongs to Sidon, and dwell there. I have commanded a widow there to feed You."
- 10 *So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, behold, the widow woman was there gathering of sticks: and he called to her, and said, Fetch me, I pray thee, a little water in a vessel, that I may drink.* So He arose and went to Zarephath. And when He came to the gate of the city, a widow was there gathering sticks. And He called to her and said, "Bring me a little water in a vessel, that I may drink."
- 11 *And as she was going to fetch it, he called to her, and said, Bring me, I pray thee, a morsel of bread in thine hand.* As she was going to bring it, He called to her and said, "Bring me a morsel of bread in Your hand."
- 12 *And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.* She said, "As the LORD Your God lives, I have nothing baked, only a handful of flour in a jar and a little oil in a jug. And now I am gathering a couple of sticks that I may go in and prepare it for myself and my son, that we may eat it and die."

- 13 *And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go and do as thou hast said: but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it unto me, and after make for thee and for thy son.* Elijah said to her, "Do not fear; go and do as you have said. But first make me a little cake of it and bring it to me, and afterward make something for yourself and your son.
- 14 *For thus saith the LORD God of Israel, The barrel of meal shall not waste, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the earth.* For thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, 'The jar of flour shall not be spent, and the jug of oil shall not be empty, until the day that the LORD sends rain upon the earth.' "
- 15 *And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.* She went and did as Elijah said. And she and he and her household ate for many days.
- 16 *And the barrel of meal wasted not, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by Elijah.* The jar of flour was not spent, neither did the jug of oil become empty, according to the word of the LORD that He spoke by Elijah.
- 17 *And it came to pass after these things, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick; and his sickness was so sore, that there was no breath left in him.* After this the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, became ill. And his illness was so severe that there was no breath left in him.
- 18 *And she said unto Elijah, What have I to do with thee, O thou man of God? art thou come unto me to call my sin to remembrance, and to slay my son?* She said to Elijah, "What have you against me, O man of God? You have come to me to bring my sin to remembrance and to cause the death of my son!"
- 19 *And he said unto her, Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into a loft, where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed.* He said to her, "Give me your son." And he took him from her arms and carried him up into the upper chamber where he lodged, and laid him on his own bed.

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| 20 | <i>And he cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, hast thou also brought evil upon the widow with whom I sojourn, by slaying her son?</i> | He cried to the LORD, "O LORD my God, have You brought calamity even upon the widow with whom I stay, by killing her son?" |
| 21 | <i>And he stretched himself upon the child three times, and cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, I pray thee, let this child's soul come into him again.</i> | Then He stretched Himself upon the child three times and cried to the LORD, "O LORD my God, let this child's soul come into Him again." |
| 22 | <i>And the LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.</i> | The LORD listened to the voice of Elijah. And the soul of the child came into him again. He revived. |
| 23 | <i>And Elijah took the child, and brought him down out of the chamber into the house, and delivered him unto his mother: and Elijah said, See, thy son liveth.</i> | Elijah took the child and brought him down from the upper chamber into the house and delivered him to his mother. And Elijah said, "See, your son lives." |
| 24 | <i>And the woman said to Elijah, Now by this I know that thou art a man of God, and that the word of the LORD in thy mouth is truth.</i> | The woman said to Elijah, "Now I know that you are a man of God, and that the word of the LORD in your mouth is truth." |

Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 4:25-26; Jas 5:17; Luke 1:17; 1 Kgs 22:14; 2 Kgs 3:14

v4 — 1 Kgs 17:9; Ps 147:9; Matt 4:4; Job 38:41; 1 Kgs 19:5-8

v6 — Ps 78:23-24; Matt 6:31-33; Ps 78:15-16; Jer 37:21; Matt 14:19-21

v7 — Isa 54:10; Isa 40:30-31

v9 — Luke 4:26; Obad 1:20; 2 Cor 4:7

v12 — Matt 15:33-34

v13 — Mal 3:10; Matt 6:33

v14 — Matt 15:36-38; Matt 14:17-20; 2 Kgs 4:42-44; 2 Kgs 3:16; 2 Kgs 7:1

v20 — Jas 5:15-18; Matt 21:22

v21 — Acts 20:10; Acts 9:40; 2 Kgs 4:33-35

v22 — Rev 11:11; Deut 32:39; John 5:28-29; Rom 14:9; Heb 11:35

v24 — John 16:30; John 3:2; John 2:11

Chapter 18

Elijah challenged the 450 prophets of Baal to a contest on Mount Carmel: the god who answered by fire would be the true God. The LORD consumed Elijah's sacrifice with fire; the people declared the LORD is God, and the prophets of Baal were slaughtered.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass after many days, that the word of the LORD came to Elijah in the third year, saying, Go, shew thyself unto Ahab; and I will send rain upon the earth.</i> | After many days the word of the LORD came to Elijah, in the third year, saying, "Go, show yourself to Ahab. I will send rain upon the earth." |
| 2 | <i>And Elijah went to shew himself unto Ahab. And there was a sore famine in Samaria.</i> | So Elijah went to show himself to Ahab. Now the famine was severe in Samaria. |
| 3 | <i>And Ahab called Obadiah, which was the governor of his house. (Now Obadiah feared the LORD greatly:</i> | Ahab called Obadiah, who was over the household. (Now Obadiah feared the LORD greatly, |
| 4 | <i>For it was so, when Jezebel cut off the prophets of the LORD, that Obadiah took an hundred prophets, and hid them by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water.)</i> | When Jezebel cut off the prophets of the LORD, Obadiah took a hundred prophets and hid them by fifties in a cave and fed them with bread and water.) |
| 5 | <i>And Ahab said unto Obadiah, Go into the land, unto all fountains of water, and unto all brooks: peradventure we may find grass to save the horses and mules alive, that we lose not all the beasts.</i> | Ahab said to Obadiah, "Go through the land to all the springs of water and to all the valleys. Perhaps we may find grass and save the horses and mules alive, and not lose some of the animals." |
| 6 | <i>So they divided the land between them to pass throughout it: Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went another way by himself.</i> | So they divided the land between them to pass through it. Ahab went in one direction by himself, and Obadiah went in another direction by himself. |

- 7 *And as Obadiah was in the way, behold, Elijah met him: and he knew him, and fell on his face, and said, Art thou that my lord Elijah?* As Obadiah was on the way, Elijah met him. And Obadiah recognized him and fell on his face and said, "Is it you, my lord Elijah?"
- 8 *And he answered him, I am: go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here.* He answered him, "It is I. Go, tell your lord, 'Elijah is here.' "
- 9 *And he said, What have I sinned, that thou wouldest deliver thy servant into the hand of Ahab, to slay me?* He said, "How have I sinned, that you would give your servant into the hand of Ahab, to kill me?"
- 10 *As the LORD thy God liveth, there is no nation or kingdom, whither my lord hath not sent to seek thee: and when they said, He is not there; he took an oath of the kingdom and nation, that they found thee not.* As the LORD Your God lives, there is no nation or kingdom where my lord has not sent to seek You. And when they would say, 'He is not here,' He would take an oath of the kingdom or nation, that they had not found You.
- 11 *And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here.* Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Elijah is here."' "
- 12 *And it shall come to pass, as soon as I am gone from thee, that the Spirit of the LORD shall carry thee whither I know not; and so when I come and tell Ahab, and he cannot find thee, he shall slay me: but I thy servant fear the LORD from my youth.* As soon as I have gone from You, the Spirit of the LORD will carry You I know not where. And so, when I come and tell Ahab and he cannot find you, he will kill me, although I Your servant have feared the LORD from my youth.
- 13 *Was it not told my lord what I did when Jezebel slew the prophets of the LORD, how I hid an hundred men of the LORD'S prophets by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water?* Has it not been told my lord what I did when Jezebel killed the prophets of the LORD, how I hid a hundred men of the LORD's prophets by fifties in a cave and fed them with bread and water?
- 14 *And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here: and he shall slay me.* Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Elijah is here"' . He will kill me."

- 15 *And Elijah said, As the LORD of hosts liveth, before whom I stand, I will surely shew myself unto him to day.* Elijah said, "As the LORD of hosts lives, before whom I stand, I will surely show myself to Him today."
- 16 *So Obadiah went to meet Ahab, and told him: and Ahab went to meet Elijah.* So Obadiah went to meet Ahab and told him. And Ahab went to meet Elijah.
- 17 *And it came to pass, when Ahab saw Elijah, that Ahab said unto him, Art thou he that troubleth Israel?* When Ahab saw Elijah, Ahab said to him, "Is it you, you troubler of Israel?"
- 18 *And he answered, I have not troubled Israel; but thou, and thy father's house, in that ye have forsaken the commandments of the LORD, and thou hast followed Baalim.* He answered, "I have not troubled Israel, but You have, and Your father's house, because You have abandoned the commandments of the LORD and followed the Baals.
- 19 *Now therefore send, and gather to me all Israel unto mount Carmel, and the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of the groves four hundred, which eat at Jezebel's table.* Now therefore send and gather all Israel to me at Mount Carmel, and the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of the groves four hundred, who eat at Jezebel's table."
- 20 *So Ahab sent unto all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together unto mount Carmel.* So Ahab sent to all the people of Israel and gathered the prophets together at Mount Carmel.
- 21 *And Elijah came unto all the people, and said, How long halt ye between two opinions? if the LORD be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him. And the people answered him not a word.* Elijah came near to all the people and said, "How long will you halt between two opinions? If the LORD is God, follow Him; but if Baal, then follow Him." And the people did not answer him a word.
- 22 *Then said Elijah unto the people, I, even I only, remain a prophet of the LORD; but Baal's prophets are four hundred and fifty men.* Then Elijah said to the people, "I, even I only, am left a prophet of the LORD, but Baal's prophets are 450 men.

- 23 *Let them therefore give us two bullocks; and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under: and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under:* Let two bulls be given to us, and let them choose one bull for themselves and cut it in pieces and lay it on the wood, but put no fire to it. And I will prepare the other bull and lay it on the wood and put no fire to it.
- 24 *And call ye on the name of your gods, and I will call on the name of the LORD: and the God that answereth by fire, let him be God. And all the people answered and said, It is well spoken.* You call upon the name of Your god. I will call upon the name of the LORD, and the God Who answers by fire, He is God." And all the people answered, "It is well spoken."
- 25 *And Elijah said unto the prophets of Baal, Choose you one bullock for yourselves, and dress it first; for ye are many; and call on the name of your gods, but put no fire under.* Then Elijah said to the prophets of Baal, "Choose for yourselves one bull and prepare it first, for you are many, and call upon the name of your god, but put no fire to it."
- 26 *And they took the bullock which was given them, and they dressed it, and called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying, O Baal, hear us. But there was no voice, nor any that answered. And they leaped upon the altar which was made.* They took the bull that was given them. They prepared it and called upon the name of Baal from morning until noon, saying, "O Baal, answer us!" But there was no voice, and no one answered. And they limped around the altar that they had made.
- 27 *And it came to pass at noon, that Elijah mocked them, and said, Cry aloud: for he is a god; either he is talking, or he is pursuing, or he is in a journey, or peradventure he sleepeth, and must be awaked.* At noon Elijah mocked them, saying, "Cry aloud, for he is a god. Either He is musing, or He is relieving himself, or He is on a journey, or perhaps He is asleep and must be awakened."

- 28 *And they cried aloud, and cut themselves after their manner with knives and lancets, till the blood gushed out upon them.* They cried aloud and cut themselves after their custom with swords and lances, until the blood gushed out upon them.
- 29 *And it came to pass, when midday was past, and they prophesied until the time of the offering of the evening sacrifice, that there was neither voice, nor any to answer, nor any that regarded.* As midday passed, they raved on until the time of the offering of the oblation, but there was no voice. No one answered; no one paid attention.
- 30 *And Elijah said unto all the people, Come near unto me. And all the people came near unto him. And he repaired the altar of the LORD that was broken down.* Then Elijah said to all the people, "Come near to me." And all the people came near to him. And he repaired the altar of the LORD that had been thrown down.
- 31 *And Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, unto whom the word of the LORD came, saying, Israel shall be thy name:* Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, to whom the word of the LORD came, saying, "Israel shall be Your name,"
- 32 *And with the stones he built an altar in the name of the LORD: and he made a trench about the altar, as great as would contain two measures of seed.* With the stones He built an altar in the name of the LORD. And He made a trench around the altar, as great as would contain two seahs of seed.
- 33 *And he put the wood in order, and cut the bullock in pieces, and laid him on the wood, and said, Fill four barrels with water, and pour it on the burnt sacrifice, and on the wood.* He put the wood in order and cut the bull in pieces and laid it on the wood. And He said, "Fill four jars with water and pour it on the burnt offering and on the wood."
- 34 *And he said, Do it the second time. And they did it the second time. And he said, Do it the third time. And they did it the third time.* He said, "Do it a second time." And they did it a second time. And He said, "Do it a third time." And they did it a third time.

- 35 *And the water ran round about the altar; and he filled the trench also with water.* The water ran around the altar and filled the trench also with water.
- 36 *And it came to pass at the time of the offering of the evening sacrifice, that Elijah the prophet came near, and said, LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, let it be known this day that thou art God in Israel, and that I am thy servant, and that I have done all these things at thy word.* At the time of the offering of the oblation, Elijah the prophet came near and said, "O LORD, God of Abraham, Isaac. Israel, let it be known this day that you are God in Israel, and that I am Your servant, and that I have done all these things at Your word.
- 37 *Hear me, O LORD, hear me, that this people may know that thou art the LORD God, and that thou hast turned their heart back again.* Answer me, O LORD, answer me, that this people may know that You, O LORD, are God, and that You have turned their hearts back."
- 38 *Then the fire of the LORD fell, and consumed the burnt sacrifice, and the wood, and the stones, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench.* Then the fire of the LORD fell and consumed the burnt offering and the wood and the stones and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench.
- 39 *And when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.* When all the people saw it, they fell on their faces and said, "The LORD, He is God; the LORD, He is God."
- 40 *And Elijah said unto them, Take the prophets of Baal; let not one of them escape. And they took them: and Elijah brought them down to the brook Kishon, and slew them there.* Elijah said to them, "Seize the prophets of Baal; let not one of them escape." And they seized them. And Elijah brought them down to the brook Kishon and slaughtered them there.
- 41 *And Elijah said unto Ahab, Get thee up, eat and drink; for there is a sound of abundance of rain.* Elijah said to Ahab, "Go up, eat and drink, for there is a sound of the rushing of rain."

- 42 *So Ahab went up to eat and to drink. And Elijah went up to the top of Carmel; and he cast himself down upon the earth, and put his face between his knees,* So Ahab went up to eat and to drink. And Elijah went up to the top of Mount Carmel. And he bowed himself down on the earth and put his face between his knees.
- 43 *And said to his servant, Go up now, look toward the sea. And he went up, and looked, and said, There is nothing. And he said, Go again seven times.* He said to his servant, "Go up now, look toward the sea." And he went up and looked and said, "There is nothing." And he said, "Go again," seven times.
- 44 *And it came to pass at the seventh time, that he said, Behold, there ariseth a little cloud out of the sea, like a man's hand. And he said, Go up, say unto Ahab, Prepare thy chariot, and get thee down, that the rain stop thee not.* At the seventh time he said, "a little cloud like a man's hand is rising from the sea." And he said, "Go up, say to Ahab, 'Prepare your chariot and go down, lest the rain stop you.' "
- 45 *And it came to pass in the mean while, that the heaven was black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. And Ahab rode, and went to Jezreel.* In a little while the heavens grew black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. And Ahab rode and went to Jezreel.
- 46 *And the hand of the LORD was on Elijah; and he girded up his loins, and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.* The hand of the LORD was on Elijah. He gathered up his garment and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 4:25; Jas 5:17; 1 Kgs 17:1; Deut 28:12

v21 — Matt 6:24; Josh 24:15; 1 Cor 10:21-22; 2 Cor 6:14-16; 2 Kgs 17:41

v24 — 1 Kgs 18:38; 1 Chr 21:26

v28 — Lev 19:28; Deut 14:1
v30 — 2 Chr 33:16; 1 Kgs 19:14; 1 Kgs 19:10
v31 — 2 Kgs 17:34; Gen 35:10; Gen 32:28
v36 — 1 Kgs 18:29; 2 Kgs 19:19; Ex 3:6; 1 Kgs 8:43; Matt 22:32
v37 — Dan 9:17-19; Luke 1:16-17
v38 — 1 Chr 21:26; Lev 9:24; 2 Chr 7:1; Judg 6:21; 1 Kgs 18:24
v41 — 1 Kgs 18:1; 1 Kgs 17:1; Eccl 9:7
v44 — Luke 12:54; Job 8:7; Zech 4:10; Mic 1:13
v46 — Ezek 3:14; Ezek 1:3; 2 Kgs 9:1; 2 Kgs 3:15; Isa 8:11

Chapter 19

Jezebel threatened to kill Elijah, and he fled to the wilderness in despair, asking God to take his life. The LORD came to him at Mount Horeb in a still small voice and commissioned him to anoint Hazael, Jehu, and Elisha.

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| <p>1 <i>And Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and withal how he had slain all the prophets with the sword.</i></p> | <p>Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and how he had killed all the prophets with the sword.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then Jezebel sent a messenger unto Elijah, saying, So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I make not thy life as the life of one of them by to morrow about this time.</i></p> | <p>Then Jezebel sent a messenger to Elijah, saying, "So may the gods do to me and more also, if I do not make your life as the life of one of them by this time tomorrow."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And when he saw that, he arose, and went for his life, and came to Beersheba, which belongeth to Judah, and left his servant there.</i></p> | <p>Then he was afraid. He arose and ran for his life and came to Beersheba, which belongs to Judah, and left his servant there.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a juniper tree: and he requested for himself that he might die; and said, It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers.</i></p> | <p>But He Himself went a day's journey into the wilderness and came and sat down under a broom tree. And He asked that He might die, saying, "It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life, for I am no better than my fathers."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And as he lay and slept under a juniper tree, behold, then an angel touched him, and said unto him, Arise and eat.</i></p> | <p>He lay down and slept under a broom tree. And an angel touched Him and said to Him, "Arise and eat."</p> |

- 6 *And he looked, and, behold, there was a cake baked on the coals, and a cruse of water at his head. And he did eat and drink, and laid him down again.* He looked, and there was at His head a cake baked on hot stones and a jar of water. And He ate and drank and lay down again.
- 7 *And the angel of the LORD came again the second time, and touched him, and said, Arise and eat; because the journey is too great for thee.* The angel of the LORD came again a second time and touched Him and said, "Arise and eat, for the journey is too great for You."
- 8 *And he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights unto Horeb the mount of God.* He arose and ate and drank, and went in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights to Horeb, the mount of God.
- 9 *And he came thither unto a cave, and lodged there; and, behold, the word of the LORD came to him, and he said unto him, What doest thou here, Elijah?* There He came to a cave and lodged in it. And the word of the LORD came to Him. He said to Him, "What are You doing here, Elijah?"
- 10 *And he said, I have been very jealous for the LORD God of hosts: for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.* He said, "I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of hosts. For the people of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down Your altars, and killed Your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left. They seek my life, to take it away."
- 11 *And he said, Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the LORD. And, behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake; but the LORD was not in the earthquake:* He said, "Go out and stand on the mount before the LORD." And the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind tore the mountains and broke in pieces the rocks before the LORD. But the LORD was not in the wind. And after the wind an earthquake. But the LORD was not in the earthquake.

- 12 *And after the earthquake a fire; but the LORD was not in the fire: and after the fire a still small voice.* After the earthquake a fire. But the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire a still small voice.
- 13 *And it was so, when Elijah heard it, that he wrapped his face in his mantle, and went out, and stood in the entering in of the cave. And, behold, there came a voice unto him, and said, What doest thou here, Elijah?* When Elijah heard it, he wrapped his face in his cloak and went out and stood at the entrance of the cave. And there came a voice to him and said, "What are you doing here, Elijah?"
- 14 *And he said, I have been very jealous for the LORD God of hosts: because the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.* He said, "I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of hosts. For the people of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down Your altars, and killed Your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left. They seek my life, to take it away."
- 15 *And the LORD said unto him, Go, return on thy way to the wilderness of Damascus: and when thou comest, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria:* The LORD said to Him, "Go, return on Your way to the wilderness of Damascus. And when You arrive, You shall anoint Hazael to be king over Syria.
- 16 *And Jehu the son of Nimshi shalt thou anoint to be king over Israel: and Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abelmeholah shalt thou anoint to be prophet in thy room.* Jehu the son of Nimshi you shall anoint to be king over Israel, and Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abel-meholah you shall anoint to be prophet in your place.
- 17 *And it shall come to pass, that him that escapeth the sword of Hazael shall Jehu slay: and him that escapeth from the sword of Jehu shall Elisha slay.* The one who escapes from the sword of Hazael shall Jehu put to death, and the one who escapes from the sword of Jehu shall Elisha put to death.
- 18 *Yet I have left me seven thousand in Israel, all the knees which have not bowed unto Baal, and every mouth which hath not kissed him.* Yet I will leave seven thousand in Israel, all the knees that have not bowed to Baal, and every mouth that has not kissed him."

- 19 *So he departed thence, and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen before him, and he with the twelfth: and Elijah passed by him, and cast his mantle upon him.* So he departed from there and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen in front of him. He was with the twelfth. Elijah passed by him and cast his cloak upon him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elisha** (ee-LY-shah) — "my God is salvation" — Elijah's successor, who received a double portion of his spirit. His ministry lasted roughly fifty years and included healing Naaman, multiplying oil and bread, raising the dead, and blinding an army. He performed twice as many recorded miracles as Elijah.

- 20 *And he left the oxen, and ran after Elijah, and said, Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said unto him, Go back again: for what have I done to thee?* He left the oxen and ran after Elijah and said, "Let me kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow you." And he said to him, "Go back again, for what have I done to you?"
- 21 *And he returned back from him, and took a yoke of oxen, and slew them, and boiled their flesh with the instruments of the oxen, and gave unto the people, and they did eat. Then he arose, and went after Elijah, and ministered unto him.* He returned from following him and took the yoke of oxen and sacrificed them and boiled their flesh with the yokes of the oxen and gave it to the people. They ate. Then he arose and went after Elijah and assisted him.

Words in this chapter:

Elisha (eh-LY-shah) — Elijah's successor who received a double portion of his spirit — performed many miracles including raising the dead; his name means 'God is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Kgs 6:31; 1 Kgs 20:10; Ruth 1:17
- v4 — Jonah 4:3; Num 11:15; Jonah 4:8; Jer 20:14-18
- v8 — Deut 9:18; Ex 34:28; Ex 3:1; Ex 24:18
- v10 — 1 Kgs 18:4; Ex 34:14; 1 Kgs 18:22
- v11 — Ezek 1:4; Ps 50:3; Isa 30:30; Job 38:1; Heb 12:26
- v12 — Job 4:16; Zech 4:6; Deut 4:33; Ex 34:6; Job 33:7
- v13 — 1 Kgs 19:9
- v17 — 2 Kgs 13:22; 2 Kgs 13:3; 2 Kgs 8:12

v18 — Rom 11:4-5; Isa 1:9; Isa 10:20-22; Hos 13:2; Ps 2:12

v19 — 2 Kgs 2:8

v20 — Matt 8:21-22; Luke 9:61-62

v21 — 2 Sam 24:22

Chapter 20

Ben-hadad of Syria besieged Samaria, but a prophet told Ahab the LORD would give him victory, and Ahab defeated the Syrians twice. Ahab spared Ben-hadad's life in exchange for a treaty, and a prophet condemned him for releasing the man God had devoted to destruction.

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| <p>1 <i>And Benhadad the king of Syria gathered all his host together: and there were thirty and two kings with him, and horses, and chariots: and he went up and besieged Samaria, and warred against it.</i></p> | <p>Ben-hadad the king of Syria gathered all his army together. Thirty-two kings were with him, and horses and chariots. And he went up and besieged Samaria and fought against it.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he sent messengers to Ahab king of Israel into the city, and said unto him, Thus saith Benhadad,</i></p> | <p>He sent messengers into the city to Ahab king of Israel and said to him, "Thus says Ben-hadad:</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Thy silver and thy gold is mine; thy wives also and thy children, even the goodliest, are mine.</i></p> | <p>'Your silver and your gold are mine; your wives and your children also are mine.' "</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the king of Israel answered and said, My lord, O king, according to thy saying, I am thine, and all that I have.</i></p> | <p>The king of Israel answered, "As you say, my lord, O king, I am yours. All that I have."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the messengers came again, and said, Thus speaketh Benhadad, saying, Although I have sent unto thee, saying, Thou shalt deliver me thy silver, and thy gold, and thy wives, and thy children;</i></p> | <p>The messengers came again and said, "Thus says Ben-hadad: 'I sent to you, saying, "Deliver to me your silver and your gold, your wives and your children."</p> |

- 6 *Yet I will send my servants unto thee to morrow about this time, and they shall search thine house, and the houses of thy servants; and it shall be, that whatsoever is pleasant in thine eyes, they shall put it in their hand, and take it away.* Nevertheless I will send my servants to you tomorrow about this time. They shall search your house and the houses of your servants and lay hands on whatever pleases you and take it away.' "
- 7 *Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land, and said, Mark, I pray you, and see how this man seeketh mischief: for he sent unto me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver, and for my gold; and I denied him not.* Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land and said, "Mark, now, and see how this man is seeking trouble, for he sent to me for my wives and my children, and for my silver and my gold. I did not refuse him."
- 8 *And all the elders and all the people said unto him, Hearken not unto him, nor consent.* All the elders and all the people said to him, "Do not listen or consent."
- 9 *Wherefore he said unto the messengers of Benhadad, Tell my lord the king, All that thou didst send for to thy servant at the first I will do: but this thing I may not do. And the messengers departed, and brought him word again.* So he said to the messengers of Ben-hadad, "Tell my lord the king, 'All that you first demanded of your servant I will do, but this thing I cannot do.' " And the messengers departed and brought him word again.
- 10 *And Benhadad sent unto him, and said, The gods do so unto me, and more also, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for handfuls for all the people that follow me.* Ben-hadad sent to him and said, "The gods do so to me and more also, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for handfuls for all the people who follow me."
- 11 *And the king of Israel answered and said, Tell him, Let not him that girdeth on his harness boast himself as he that putteth it off.* The king of Israel answered, "Tell him, 'Let not him who straps on his armor boast himself as he who takes it off.' "

- 12 *And it came to pass, when Benhadad heard this message, as he was drinking, he and the kings in the pavilions, that he said unto his servants, Set yourselves in array. And they set themselves in array against the city.* When Ben-hadad heard this message as he was drinking with the kings in the booths, he said to his men, "Take your positions." And they took their positions against the city.
- 13 *And, behold, there came a prophet unto Ahab king of Israel, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Hast thou seen all this great multitude? behold, I will deliver it into thine hand this day; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.* A prophet came near to Ahab king of Israel and said, "Thus says the LORD, Have You seen all this great crowd? I will give it into Your hand this day, and You shall know that I am the LORD."
- 14 *And Ahab said, By whom? And he said, Thus saith the LORD, Even by the young men of the princes of the provinces. Then he said, Who shall order the battle? And he answered, Thou.* Ahab said, "By whom?" He said, "Thus says the LORD, By the servants of the district governors." Then He said, "Who shall begin the battle?" He answered, "You."
- 15 *Then he numbered the young men of the princes of the provinces, and they were two hundred and thirty two: and after them he numbered all the people, even all the children of Israel, being seven thousand.* Then He mustered the servants of the district governors. They were 232. And after them He mustered all the people of Israel, seven thousand.
- 16 *And they went out at noon. But Benhadad was drinking himself drunk in the pavilions, he and the kings, the thirty and two kings that helped him.* They went out at noon, while Ben-hadad was drinking Himself drunk in the booths, He and the thirty-two kings who helped Him.
- 17 *And the young men of the princes of the provinces went out first; and Benhadad sent out, and they told him, saying, There are men come out of Samaria.* The servants of the district governors went out first. And Ben-hadad sent out scouts. They reported to Him, "Men are coming out from Samaria."

- 18 *And he said, Whether they be come out for peace, take them alive; or whether they be come out for war, take them alive.* He said, "If they have come out for peace, take them alive. Or if they have come out for war, take them alive."
- 19 *So these young men of the princes of the provinces came out of the city, and the army which followed them.* So these went out of the city, the servants of the district governors and the army that followed them.
- 20 *And they slew every one his man: and the Syrians fled; and Israel pursued them: and Benhadad the king of Syria escaped on an horse with the horsemen.* Each struck down His man. The Syrians fled. Israel pursued them, but Ben-hadad king of Syria escaped on a horse with horsemen.
- 21 *And the king of Israel went out, and smote the horses and chariots, and slew the Syrians with a great slaughter.* The king of Israel went out and struck the horses and chariots, and struck the Syrians with a great blow.
- 22 *And the prophet came to the king of Israel, and said unto him, Go, strengthen thyself, and mark and see what thou doest: for at the return of the year the king of Syria will come up against thee.* Then the prophet came near to the king of Israel and said to him, "Come, strengthen yourself, and consider carefully what you should do, for in the spring the king of Syria will come up against you."
- 23 *And the servants of the king of Syria said unto him, Their gods are gods of the hills; therefore they were stronger than we; but let us fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they.* The servants of the king of Syria said to him, "Their gods are gods of the hills, and so they were stronger than we. But let us fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they."
- 24 *And do this thing, Take the kings away, every man out of his place, and put captains in their rooms:* Do this: remove the kings, each from his post, and put commanders in their places,

- 25 *And number thee an army, like the army that thou hast lost, horse for horse, and chariot for chariot: and we will fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they. And he hearkened unto their voice, and did so.* Number an army like the army you lost, horse for horse, and chariot for chariot. Then we will fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they." And he listened to their voice and did so.
- 26 *And it came to pass at the return of the year, that Benhadad numbered the Syrians, and went up to Aphek, to fight against Israel.* In the spring, Ben-hadad mustered the Syrians and went up to Aphek to fight against Israel.
- 27 *And the children of Israel were numbered, and were all present, and went against them: and the children of Israel pitched before them like two little flocks of kids; but the Syrians filled the country.* The people of Israel were mustered and were provisioned and went against them. The people of Israel encamped before them like two little flocks of goats, but the Syrians filled the country.
- 28 *And there came a man of God, and spake unto the king of Israel, and said, Thus saith the LORD, Because the Syrians have said, The LORD is God of the hills, but he is not God of the valleys, therefore will I deliver all this great multitude into thine hand, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* A man of God came near and said to the king of Israel, "Thus says the LORD, 'Because the Syrians have said, "The LORD is a god of the hills but he is not a god of the valleys," therefore I will give all this great crowd into your hand, and you shall know that I am the LORD.' "
- 29 *And they pitched one over against the other seven days. And so it was, that in the seventh day the battle was joined: and the children of Israel slew of the Syrians an hundred thousand footmen in one day.* They encamped opposite one another seven days. Then on the seventh day the battle was joined. And the people of Israel struck down of the Syrians 100,000 foot soldiers in one day.

- 30 *But the rest fled to Aphek, into the city; and there a wall fell upon twenty and seven thousand of the men that were left. And Benhadad fled, and came into the city, into an inner chamber.* The rest fled into the city of Aphek, and the wall fell upon 27,000 men who were left. Ben-hadad also fled and entered the city and went from chamber to chamber.
- 31 *And his servants said unto him, Behold now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings: let us, I pray thee, put sackcloth on our loins, and ropes upon our heads, and go out to the king of Israel: peradventure he will save thy life.* His servants said to him, " now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings. Let us put sackcloth on our waists and ropes on our heads and go out to the king of Israel. Perhaps he will spare your life."
- 32 *So they girded sackcloth on their loins, and put ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said, Thy servant Benhadad saith, I pray thee, let me live. And he said, Is he yet alive? he is my brother.* So they tied sackcloth around their waists and put ropes on their heads and went to the king of Israel and said, "Your servant Ben-hadad says, 'Please let me live.' " And he said, "Does he still live? He is my brother."
- 33 *Now the men did diligently observe whether any thing would come from him, and did hastily catch it: and they said, Thy brother Benhadad. Then he said, Go ye, bring him. Then Benhadad came forth to him; and he caused him to come up into the chariot.* Now the men were watching for a sign. They quickly took it up from him and said, "Yes, Ben-hadad is your brother." Then he said, "Go and bring him." Then Ben-hadad came out to him. He caused him to come up into the chariot.
- 34 *And Benhadad said unto him, The cities, which my father took from thy father, I will restore; and thou shalt make streets for thee in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria. Then said Ahab, I will send thee away with this covenant. So he made a covenant with him, and sent him away.* Ben-hadad said to him, "The cities that my father took from your father I will restore, and you may establish bazaars for yourself in Damascus, as my father did in Samaria." And Ahab said, "I will let you go on these terms." So he made a covenant with him and let him go.

- 35 *And a certain man of the sons of the prophets said unto his neighbour in the word of the LORD, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man refused to smite him.* A certain man of the sons of the prophets said to His fellow at the command of the LORD, "Strike me, please." But the man refused to strike him.
- 36 *Then said he unto him, Because thou hast not obeyed the voice of the LORD, behold, as soon as thou art departed from me, a lion shall slay thee. And as soon as he was departed from him, a lion found him, and slew him.* Then He said to Him, "Because You have not obeyed the voice of the LORD, as soon as You have gone from me, a lion shall strike You down." And as soon as He had departed from Him, a lion met Him and struck Him down.
- 37 *Then he found another man, and said, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man smote him, so that in smiting he wounded him.* Then he found another man and said, "Strike me, please." And the man struck him and wounded him.
- 38 *So the prophet departed, and waited for the king by the way, and disguised himself with ashes upon his face.* So the prophet departed and waited for the king by the way, disguising himself with a bandage over his eyes.
- 39 *And as the king passed by, he cried unto the king: and he said, Thy servant went out into the midst of the battle; and, behold, a man turned aside, and brought a man unto me, and said, Keep this man: if by any means he be missing, then shall thy life be for his life, or else thou shalt pay a talent of silver.* As the king passed, he cried to the king and said, "Your servant went out into the midst of the battle, and a soldier turned and brought a man to me and said, 'Guard this man; if by any means he is missing, your life shall be for his life, or else you shall pay a talent of silver.'
- 40 *And as thy servant was busy here and there, he was gone. And the king of Israel said unto him, So shall thy judgment be; thyself hast decided it.* As your servant was busy here and there, he was gone." The king of Israel said to him, "So shall your judgment be; you yourself have decided it."

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| <p>41 <i>And he hasted, and took the ashes away from his face; and the king of Israel discerned him that he was of the prophets.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And he said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Because thou hast let go out of thy hand a man whom I appointed to utter destruction, therefore thy life shall go for his life, and thy people for his people.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And the king of Israel went to his house heavy and displeased, and came to Samaria.</i></p> | <p>Then he hurried to take the bandage away from his eyes, and the king of Israel recognized him as one of the prophets.</p> <p>He said to Him, "Thus says the LORD, 'Because You have let go out of Your hand the man whom I had devoted to destruction, therefore Your life shall be for His life, and Your people for His people.' "</p> <p>The king of Israel went to his house vexed and sullen and came to Samaria.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ahab (AY-hab) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Samaria (sah-MAIR-ee-ah) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 15:18
v7 — 2 Kgs 5:7
v10 — 1 Kgs 19:2
v11 — Prov 27:1
v12 — 1 Kgs 16:9
v13 — 1 Kgs 20:28
v22 — 2 Sam 11:1; 1 Kgs 20:26; 1 Kgs 20:13
v28 — 1 Kgs 20:13
v30 — 2 Chr 18:24; 1 Kgs 22:25
v34 — 1 Kgs 15:20
v42 — 1 Kgs 22:31-37
v43 — 1 Kgs 21:4

Chapter 21

Ahab coveted Naboth's vineyard, and Jezebel arranged Naboth's murder through false accusations. Elijah confronted Ahab and pronounced that dogs would lick his blood and

Jezebel would be eaten by dogs; Ahab humbled himself, and God delayed the judgment.

- 1 *And it came to pass after these things, that Naboth the Jezreelite had a vineyard, which was in Jezreel, hard by the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.*

Now Naboth the Jezreelite had a vineyard in Jezreel, beside the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.
- 2 *And Ahab spake unto Naboth, saying, Give me thy vineyard, that I may have it for a garden of herbs, because it is near unto my house: and I will give thee for it a better vineyard than it; or, if it seem good to thee, I will give thee the worth of it in money.*

After this Ahab said to Naboth, "Give me your vineyard, that I may have it for a vegetable garden, because it is near my house. I will give you a better vineyard for it; or, if it seems good to you, I will give you its value in money."
- 3 *And Naboth said to Ahab, The LORD forbid it me, that I should give the inheritance of my fathers unto thee.*

But Naboth said to Ahab, "The LORD forbid that I should give you the inheritance of my fathers."
- 4 *And Ahab came into his house heavy and displeased because of the word which Naboth the Jezreelite had spoken to him: for he had said, I will not give thee the inheritance of my fathers. And he laid him down upon his bed, and turned away his face, and would eat no bread.*

Ahab went into his house vexed and sullen because of what Naboth the Jezreelite had said to him, for he had said, "I will not give you the inheritance of my fathers." And he lay down on his bed and turned away his face and would eat no food.
- 5 *But Jezebel his wife came to him, and said unto him, Why is thy spirit so sad, that thou eatest no bread?*

But Jezebel his wife came to him and said to him, "Why is your spirit so vexed that you eat no food?"
- 6 *And he said unto her, Because I spake unto Naboth the Jezreelite, and said unto him, Give me thy vineyard for money; or else, if it please thee, I will give thee another vineyard for it: and he answered, I will not give thee my vineyard.*

He said to her, "Because I spoke to Naboth the Jezreelite and said to him, 'Give me your vineyard for money, or else, if it please you, I will give you another vineyard for it.' And he answered, 'I will not give you my vineyard.' "

- 7 *And Jezebel his wife said unto him, Dost thou now govern the kingdom of Israel? arise, and eat bread, and let thine heart be merry: I will give thee the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite.* Jezebel his wife said to him, "Do you now govern Israel? Arise and eat bread and let your heart be cheerful; I will give you the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite."
- 8 *So she wrote letters in Ahab's name, and sealed them with his seal, and sent the letters unto the elders and to the nobles that were in his city, dwelling with Naboth.* So she wrote letters in Ahab's name and sealed them with his seal. She sent the letters to the elders and the leaders who lived with Naboth in his city.
- 9 *And she wrote in the letters, saying, Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people:* She wrote in the letters, "Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth at the head of the people.
- 10 *And set two men, sons of Belial, before him, to bear witness against him, saying, Thou didst blaspheme God and the king. And then carry him out, and stone him, that he may die.* Set two worthless men opposite him, and let them bring a charge against him, saying, 'You have cursed God and the king.' Then take him out and stone him to death."
- 11 *And the men of his city, even the elders and the nobles who were the inhabitants in his city, did as Jezebel had sent unto them, and as it was written in the letters which she had sent unto them.* The men of his city, the elders and the leaders who lived in his city, did as Jezebel had sent word to them. As it was written in the letters that she had sent to them,
- 12 *They proclaimed a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people.* They proclaimed a fast and set Naboth at the head of the people.
- 13 *And there came in two men, children of Belial, and sat before him: and the men of Belial witnessed against him, even against Naboth, in the presence of the people, saying, Naboth did blaspheme God and the king. Then they carried him forth out of the city, and stoned him with stones, that he died.* The two worthless men came in and sat opposite him. And the worthless men brought a charge against Naboth in the presence of the people, saying, "Naboth cursed God and the king." So they took him outside the city and stoned him to death with stones.

- 14 *Then they sent to Jezebel, saying, Naboth is stoned, and is dead.* Then they sent to Jezebel, saying, "Naboth has been stoned; he is dead."
- 15 *And it came to pass, when Jezebel heard that Naboth was stoned, and was dead, that Jezebel said to Ahab, Arise, take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which he refused to give thee for money: for Naboth is not alive, but dead.* As soon as Jezebel heard that Naboth had been stoned and was dead, Jezebel said to Ahab, "Arise, take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which he refused to give you for money, for Naboth is not alive, but dead."
- 16 *And it came to pass, when Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, that Ahab rose up to go down to the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take possession of it.* As soon as Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, Ahab arose to go down to the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take possession of it.
- 17 *And the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,
- 18 *Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, which is in Samaria: behold, he is in the vineyard of Naboth, whither he is gone down to possess it.* "Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, who is in Samaria; he is in the vineyard of Naboth, where he has gone to take possession.
- 19 *And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Hast thou killed, and also taken possession? And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, Thus saith the LORD, In the place where dogs licked the blood of Naboth shall dogs lick thy blood, even thine.* You shall say to Him, "Thus says the LORD, "Have You killed and also taken possession?" And You shall say to Him, "Thus says the LORD: "In the place where dogs licked up the blood of Naboth shall dogs lick Your own blood.""
- 20 *And Ahab said to Elijah, Hast thou found me, O mine enemy? And he answered, I have found thee: because thou hast sold thyself to work evil in the sight of the LORD.* Ahab said to Elijah, "Have you found me, O my enemy?" He answered, "I have found you, because you have sold yourself to do what is evil in the sight of the LORD.

- 21 *Behold, I will bring evil upon thee, and will take away thy posterity, and will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel,* I will bring disaster upon you. I will utterly burn you up, and will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, both bond and free, in Israel.
- 22 *And will make thine house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah, for the provocation wherewith thou hast provoked me to anger, and made Israel to sin.* I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah, for the anger to which you have provoked me, and because you have made Israel to sin.
- 23 *And of Jezebel also spake the LORD, saying, The dogs shall eat Jezebel by the wall of Jezreel.* Of Jezebel the LORD also said, 'The dogs shall eat Jezebel within the walls of Jezreel.'
- 24 *Him that dieth of Ahab in the city the dogs shall eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat.* Anyone belonging to Ahab who dies in the city the dogs shall eat, and anyone of his who dies in the open country the birds of the heavens shall eat."
- 25 *But there was none like unto Ahab, which did sell himself to work wickedness in the sight of the LORD, whom Jezebel his wife stirred up.* (There was none who sold Himself to do what was evil in the sight of the LORD like Ahab, whom Jezebel his wife incited.
- 26 *And he did very abominably in following idols, according to all things as did the Amorites, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.)* He acted very abominably in going after idols, as the Amorites had done, whom the LORD cast out before the people of Israel.)
- 27 *And it came to pass, when Ahab heard those words, that he rent his clothes, and put sackcloth upon his flesh, and fasted, and lay in sackcloth, and went softly.* When Ahab heard those words, he tore his clothes and put sackcloth on his flesh and fasted and lay in sackcloth and went about dejectedly.
- 28 *And the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,* The word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,

29	<i>Seest thou how Ahab humbleth himself before me? because he humbleth himself before me, I will not bring the evil in his days: but in his son's days will I bring the evil upon his house.</i>	"Have you seen how Ahab has humbled himself before me? Because he has humbled himself before me, I will not bring the disaster in his days; but in his son's days I will bring the disaster upon his house."
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Words in this chapter:

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Jezebel (*JEZ-eh-bel*) — Ahab's Phoenician queen — aggressively promoted Baal worship and persecuted the prophets of God; killed Naboth to take his vineyard; eaten by dogs as prophesied.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Num 36:7; Lev 25:23; Ezek 46:18
- v4 — 1 Kgs 20:43
- v10 — Ex 22:28; Acts 6:11
- v12 — Isa 58:4
- v20 — Rom 7:14; 2 Kgs 17:17; 1 Kgs 18:17; 1 Kgs 21:25
- v21 — 1 Kgs 14:10
- v22 — 1 Kgs 16:3
- v24 — 1 Kgs 14:11; 1 Kgs 16:4
- v25 — 1 Kgs 21:20; Prov 22:14; 1 Kgs 16:30-33
- v26 — 2 Kgs 21:11; Gen 15:16
- v27 — 2 Kgs 6:30; Gen 37:34
- v29 — 2 Pet 3:9; Mic 7:18; 2 Kgs 9:25-26; Ps 86:15; 2 Kgs 9:33-10:7

<i>Jehoshaphat of Judah — 870–848 BC</i>
<i>Ahaziah of Israel — 853–852 BC</i>

Chapter 22

Ahab and Jehoshaphat allied to fight Syria at Ramoth-gilead, despite Micaiah's prophecy that Ahab would die. Ahab disguised himself but was struck by a random arrow and died; dogs licked his blood as Elijah had prophesied.

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| 1 | <i>And they continued three years without war between Syria and Israel.</i> | For three years Syria and Israel continued without war. |
| 2 | <i>And it came to pass in the third year, that Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel.</i> | But in the third year Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel. |
| 3 | <i>And the king of Israel said unto his servants, Know ye that Ramoth in Gilead is ours, and we be still, and take it not out of the hand of the king of Syria?</i> | The king of Israel said to his servants, "Do you know that Ramoth-gilead belongs to us. We keep quiet and do not take it out of the hand of the king of Syria?" |
| 4 | <i>And he said unto Jehoshaphat, Wilt thou go with me to battle to Ramothgilead? And Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, I am as thou art, my people as thy people, my horses as thy horses.</i> | He said to Jehoshaphat, "Will you go with me to battle at Ramoth-gilead?" And Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "I am as you are, my people as your people, my horses as your horses." |
| 5 | <i>And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Enquire, I pray thee, at the word of the LORD to day.</i> | Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "Inquire first for the word of the LORD." |
| 6 | <i>Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, about four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall I go against Ramothgilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for the Lord shall deliver it into the hand of the king.</i> | Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, about 400 men, and said to them, "Shall I go to battle against Ramoth-gilead, or shall I refrain?" And they said, "Go up, for the Lord will give it into the hand of the king." |
| 7 | <i>But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we might enquire of him?</i> | But Jehoshaphat said, "Is there not here another prophet of the LORD of whom we may inquire?" |

- 8 *And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man, Micaiah the son of Imlah, by whom we may enquire of the LORD: but I hate him; for he doth not prophesy good concerning me, but evil. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so.* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of the LORD, Micaiah the son of Imlah. But I hate Him, for He never prophesies good concerning me, but evil." And Jehoshaphat said, "Let not the king say so."
- 9 *Then the king of Israel called an officer, and said, Hasten hither Micaiah the son of Imlah.* Then the king of Israel summoned an officer and said, "Bring quickly Micaiah the son of Imlah."
- 10 *And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah sat each on his throne, having put on their robes, in a void place in the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets prophesied before them.* Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were sitting on their thrones, arrayed in their robes, at the threshing floor at the entrance of the gate of Samaria. All the prophets were prophesying before them.
- 11 *And Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made him horns of iron: and he said, Thus saith the LORD, With these shalt thou push the Syrians, until thou have consumed them.* Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made for himself horns of iron and said, "Thus says the LORD, 'With these You shall push the Syrians until they are destroyed.' "
- 12 *And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramothgilead, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the king's hand.* All the prophets prophesied so and said, "Go up to Ramoth-gilead and triumph; the LORD will give it into the hand of the king."
- 13 *And the messenger that was gone to call Micaiah spake unto him, saying, Behold now, the words of the prophets declare good unto the king with one mouth: let thy word, I pray thee, be like the word of one of them, and speak that which is good.* The messenger who went to summon Micaiah said to him, " the words of the prophets with one accord are favorable to the king. Let your word be like the word of one of them, and speak favorably."

- 14 *And Micaiah said, As the LORD liveth, what the LORD saith unto me, that will I speak.* But Micaiah said, "As the LORD lives, what the LORD says to me, that I will speak."
- 15 *So he came to the king. And the king said unto him, Micaiah, shall we go against Ramothgilead to battle, or shall we forbear? And he answered him, Go, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the hand of the king.* When He had come to the king, the king said to him, "Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall we refrain?" And He answered Him, "Go up and triumph; the LORD will give it into the hand of the king."
- 16 *And the king said unto him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou tell me nothing but that which is true in the name of the LORD?* But the king said to him, "How many times shall I make You swear that You speak to me nothing but the truth in the name of the LORD?"
- 17 *And he said, I saw all Israel scattered upon the hills, as sheep that have not a shepherd: and the LORD said, These have no master: let them return every man to his house in peace.* He said, "I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. And the LORD said, 'These have no master; let each return to His home in peace.'"
- 18 *And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, Did I not tell thee that he would prophesy no good concerning me, but evil?* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Did I not tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?"
- 19 *And he said, Hear thou therefore the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on his throne, and all the host of heaven standing by him on his right hand and on his left.* Micaiah said, "Therefore hear the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on His throne. All the host of heaven standing beside Him on His right hand and on His left;
- 20 *And the LORD said, Who shall persuade Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramothgilead? And one said on this manner, and another said on that manner.* The LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gilead?' And one said one thing, and another said another.

- 21 *And there came forth a spirit, and stood before the LORD, and said, I will persuade him.* Then a spirit came forward and stood before the LORD, saying, 'I will entice Him.'
- 22 *And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith? And he said, I will go forth, and I will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And he said, Thou shalt persuade him, and prevail also: go forth, and do so.* The LORD said to Him, 'By what means?' And He said, 'I will go out, and will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all His prophets.' And He said, 'You are to entice Him, and You shall succeed; go out and do so.'
- 23 *Now therefore, behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil concerning thee.* Now therefore the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these Your prophets; the LORD has declared disaster for You."
- 24 *But Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah went near, and smote Micaiah on the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?* Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near and struck Micaiah on the cheek and said, "How did the Spirit of the LORD go from me to speak to You?"
- 25 *And Micaiah said, Behold, thou shalt see in that day, when thou shalt go into an inner chamber to hide thyself.* Micaiah said, " you shall see on that day when You go into an inner chamber to hide Yourself."
- 26 *And the king of Israel said, Take Micaiah, and carry him back unto Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son;* The king of Israel said, "Seize Micaiah, and take him back to Amon the governor of the city and to Joash the king's son,
- 27 *And say, Thus saith the king, Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I come in peace.* Say, "Thus says the king, "Put this fellow in prison and feed him with meager bread and meager water, until I come in peace.""
- 28 *And Micaiah said, If thou return at all in peace, the LORD hath not spoken by me. And he said, Hearken, O people, every one of you.* Micaiah said, "If You return in peace, the LORD has not spoken by me." And He said, "Hear, all You peoples!"

- 29 *So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramothgilead.* So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead.
- 30 *And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and enter into the battle; but put thou on thy robes. And the king of Israel disguised himself, and went into the battle.* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will disguise myself and go into battle, but you wear your robes." And the king of Israel disguised himself and went into battle.
- 31 *But the king of Syria commanded his thirty and two captains that had rule over his chariots, saying, Fight neither with small nor great, save only with the king of Israel.* Now the king of Syria had commanded the thirty-two captains of his chariots, "Fight with neither small nor great, but only with the king of Israel."
- 32 *And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, Surely it is the king of Israel. And they turned aside to fight against him: and Jehoshaphat cried out.* When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, "It is surely the king of Israel." So they turned to fight against him. And Jehoshaphat cried out.
- 33 *And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, that they turned back from pursuing him.* When the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him.
- 34 *And a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between the joints of the harness: wherefore he said unto the driver of his chariot, Turn thine hand, and carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.* But a certain man drew his bow at random and struck the king of Israel between the scale armor and the breastplate. Therefore he said to the driver of his chariot, "Turn around and carry me out of the battle, for I am wounded."

- 35 *And the battle increased that day: and the king was stayed up in his chariot against the Syrians, and died at even: and the blood ran out of the wound into the midst of the chariot.* The battle continued that day, and the king was propped up in his chariot facing the Syrians, until at evening he died. And the blood of the wound flowed into the bottom of the chariot.
- 36 *And there went a proclamation throughout the host about the going down of the sun, saying, Every man to his city, and every man to his own country.* About sunset a cry went through the army, "Every man to his city, and every man to his country!"
- 37 *So the king died, and was brought to Samaria; and they buried the king in Samaria.* So the king died, and was brought to Samaria. And they buried the king in Samaria.
- 38 *And one washed the chariot in the pool of Samaria; and the dogs licked up his blood; and they washed his armour; according unto the word of the LORD which he spake.* They washed the chariot by the pool of Samaria, and the dogs licked up His blood, and they washed his armor, according to the word of the LORD that He had spoken.
- 39 *Now the rest of the acts of Ahab, and all that he did, and the ivory house which he made, and all the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Ahab and all that he did, and the ivory house that he built and all the cities that he built, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 40 *So Ahab slept with his fathers; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his stead.* So Ahab slept with his fathers, and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place.
- 41 *And Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.* Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.
- 42 *Jehoshaphat was thirty and five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.* Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.

- 43 *And he walked in all the ways of Asa his father; he turned not aside from it, doing that which was right in the eyes of the LORD: nevertheless the high places were not taken away; for the people offered and burnt incense yet in the high places.* He walked in all the way of Asa his father. He did not turn aside from it, doing what was right in the sight of the LORD. Yet the high places were not taken away, and the people still sacrificed and made offerings on the high places.
- 44 *And Jehoshaphat made peace with the king of Israel.* Jehoshaphat also made peace with the king of Israel.
- 45 *Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, and his might that he shewed, and how he warred, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat. His might that he showed, and how he warred, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 46 *And the remnant of the sodomites, which remained in the days of his father Asa, he took out of the land.* The remnant of the sodomites who remained in the days of his father Asa he exterminated from the land.
- 47 *There was then no king in Edom: a deputy was king.* There was no king in Edom; a deputy was king.
- 48 *Jehoshaphat made ships of Tharshish to go to Ophir for gold: but they went not; for the ships were broken at Eziongeber.* Jehoshaphat made ships of Tarshish to go to Ophir for gold. But they did not go, for the ships were wrecked at Ezion-geber.
- 49 *Then said Ahaziah the son of Ahab unto Jehoshaphat, Let my servants go with thy servants in the ships. But Jehoshaphat would not.* Then Ahaziah the son of Ahab said to Jehoshaphat, "Let my servants go with your servants in the ships," but Jehoshaphat was not willing.
- 50 *And Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Jehoram his son reigned in his stead.* Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father, and Jehoram his son reigned in his place.

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| 51 | <i>Ahaziah the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and reigned two years over Israel.</i> | Ahaziah the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah. He reigned two years over Israel. |
| 52 | <i>And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of his father, and in the way of his mother, and in the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin:</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and walked in the way of His father and in the way of His mother and in the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin. |
| 53 | <i>For he served Baal, and worshipped him, and provoked to anger the LORD God of Israel, according to all that his father had done.</i> | He served Baal and worshiped Him and provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger in every way that His father had done. |

Words in this chapter:

breastplate — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Prov 3:5-6; 2 Chr 18:4-5; 2 Kgs 3:11
- v8 — John 17:14; John 7:7; John 3:19-21; Amos 5:10
- v17 — Num 27:17; Matt 9:36; 1 Kgs 22:34-36
- v19 — Job 2:1; Job 1:6; Dan 7:9-10; Isa 6:1-3; Matt 18:10
- v20 — Ezek 14:9; Job 12:16
- v23 — Ezek 14:9; Isa 6:9-10; Matt 24:24-25; Isa 3:11; 2 Chr 25:16
- v28 — Num 16:29; Mic 1:2
- v31 — 1 Kgs 20:24; 2 Chr 18:30
- v43 — 1 Kgs 15:14; 2 Kgs 12:3
- v46 — 1 Kgs 14:24; 1 Kgs 15:12
- v47 — 2 Kgs 3:9; 2 Sam 8:14
- v48 — 1 Kgs 10:22; 1 Kgs 9:26

2 Kings

Author: Unknown — Jewish tradition credits Jeremiah, but the book was likely compiled by unnamed prophetic authors from court records and prophetic sources over several generations.

Date written: Final form c. 560–550 BC, after the fall of Jerusalem, possibly in Babylon.

Written to: The exiled nation of Israel and Judah, to explain why they were in captivity and what it meant.

Setting: 2 Kings opens with Elijah's translation and closes with the king of Judah eating at the table of Babylon's king — a seventy-year arc from the peak of prophetic ministry to the depths of national ruin.

Where this sits historically: c. 850–560 BC — the divided kingdom through the fall of Samaria (722 BC, Assyria) and the fall of Jerusalem (586 BC, Babylon); the rise of Assyria and Babylon dominates the period.

Contemporaries: The prophets Elisha, Jonah, Amos, Hosea, Isaiah, Micah, Jeremiah, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, and Nahum all preach during these centuries; Assyria's Tiglath-Pileser III, Sargon II, and Sennacherib; Babylon's Nebuchadnezzar; Daniel and Ezekiel are taken into exile while these events unfold.

Big themes:

- The prophetic word fulfilled — every major event, from Jehu's coup to the fall of Samaria to the destruction of Jerusalem, happens exactly as a prophet foretold
- The divided kingdom unravels — Israel (northern) falls to Assyria in 722 BC; Judah (southern) falls to Babylon in 586 BC
- Elisha — his ministry dominates the early chapters, with a concentration of miracles unmatched since Moses
- Hezekiah and Josiah — two kings who genuinely sought God, and whose reforms show what faithfulness looks like even in decline
- Covenant consequences — the exile is not bad luck; it is the curses of Deuteronomy 28 falling exactly as Moses said they would

Key passages: 2 Kgs 2:11; 5:14; 17:7–8; 19:35; 22:8

How it fits: 2 Kings is the final chapter of the Deuteronomistic history (Deuteronomy–Kings). It answers the question Israel asked in exile: "Why did this happen to us?" The answer is covenantal. 2 Chronicles retells the same story from a priestly perspective; Isaiah, Jeremiah, and Ezekiel prophesied during the events of 2 Kings' later chapters.

Chapter 1

Ahaziah king of Israel fell through a lattice and sent messengers to inquire of Baal-zebub, but Elijah intercepted them with a message of death. Two companies of fifty soldiers sent to seize Elijah were consumed by fire from heaven; Ahaziah died as the LORD had spoken.

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| 1 | <i>Then Moab rebelled against Israel after the death of Ahab.</i> | After the death of Ahab, Moab rebelled against Israel. |
| 2 | <i>And Ahaziah fell down through a lattice in his upper chamber that was in Samaria, and was sick: and he sent messengers, and said unto them, Go, enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron whether I shall recover of this disease.</i> | Now Ahaziah fell through the lattice in his upper chamber in Samaria, and lay sick. So he sent messengers, telling them, "Go, inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron, whether I shall recover from this sickness." |
| 3 | <i>But the angel of the LORD said to Elijah the Tishbite, Arise, go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria, and say unto them, Is it not because there is not a God in Israel, that ye go to enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron?</i> | But the angel of the LORD said to Elijah the Tishbite, "Arise, go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria, and say to them, 'Is it because there is no God in Israel that You are going to inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron?' |
| 4 | <i>Now therefore thus saith the LORD, Thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die. And Elijah departed.</i> | Now therefore thus says the LORD, 'You shall not come down from the bed to which You have gone up, but You shall surely die.' " So Elijah departed. |
| 5 | <i>And when the messengers turned back unto him, he said unto them, Why are ye now turned back?</i> | The messengers returned to the king. He said to them, "Why have you returned?" |

- 6 *And they said unto him, There came a man up to meet us, and said unto us, Go, turn again unto the king that sent you, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Is it not because there is not a God in Israel, that thou sendest to enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron? therefore thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.* They said to him, "There came a man to meet us, and said to us, 'Go back to the king who sent you, and say to him, Thus says the LORD, Is it because there is no God in Israel that you are sending to inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore you shall not come down from the bed to which you have gone up, but you shall surely die.' "
- 7 *And he said unto them, What manner of man was he which came up to meet you, and told you these words?* He said to them, "What kind of man was He who came to meet you and told you these things?"
- 8 *And they answered him, He was an hairy man, and girt with a girdle of leather about his loins. And he said, It is Elijah the Tishbite.* They answered him, "He wore a garment of hair, with a belt of leather around his waist." And he said, "It is Elijah the Tishbite."
- 9 *Then the king sent unto him a captain of fifty with his fifty. And he went up to him: and, behold, he sat on the top of an hill. And he spake unto him, Thou man of God, the king hath said, Come down.* Then the king sent to him a captain of fifty men with his fifty. He went up to Elijah, who was sitting on the top of a hill, and said to him, "O man of God, the king says, 'Come down.' "
- 10 *And Elijah answered and said to the captain of fifty, If I be a man of God, then let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And there came down fire from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.* But Elijah answered the captain of fifty, "If I am a man of God, let fire come down from heaven and consume you and your fifty." Then fire came down from heaven and consumed Him and His fifty.
- 11 *Again also he sent unto him another captain of fifty with his fifty. And he answered and said unto him, O man of God, thus hath the king said, Come down quickly.* Again the king sent to him another captain of fifty men with his fifty. And he said to him, "O man of God, this is the king's order, 'Come down quickly!'"

- 12 *And Elijah answered and said unto them, If I be a man of God, let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And the fire of God came down from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.* But Elijah answered them, "If I am a man of God, let fire come down from heaven and consume you and your fifty." Then the fire of God came down from heaven and consumed Him and His fifty.
- 13 *And he sent again a captain of the third fifty with his fifty. And the third captain of fifty went up, and came and fell on his knees before Elijah, and besought him, and said unto him, O man of God, I pray thee, let my life, and the life of these fifty thy servants, be precious in thy sight.* Again the king sent the captain of a third fifty with his fifty. And the third captain of fifty went up and came and fell on his knees before Elijah and pleaded with him, "O man of God, please let my life, and the life of these fifty servants of yours, be precious in your sight.
- 14 *Behold, there came fire down from heaven, and burnt up the two captains of the former fifties with their fifties: therefore let my life now be precious in thy sight.* Fire came down from heaven and consumed the two former captains of fifty men with their fifties, but now let my life be precious in your sight."
- 15 *And the angel of the LORD said unto Elijah, Go down with him: be not afraid of him. And he arose, and went down with him unto the king.* Then the angel of the LORD said to Elijah, "Go down with him; do not be afraid of him." So he arose and went down with him to the king
- 16 *And he said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Forasmuch as thou hast sent messengers to enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron, is it not because there is no God in Israel to enquire of his word? therefore thou shalt not come down off that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.* Said to Him, "Thus says the LORD, 'Because You have sent messengers to inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron—is it because there is no God in Israel to inquire of His word?—therefore You shall not come down from the bed to which You have gone up, but You shall surely die.' "

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| <p>17 <i>So he died according to the word of the LORD which Elijah had spoken. And Jehoram reigned in his stead in the second year of Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah; because he had no son.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Ahaziah which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?</i></p> | <p>So He died according to the word of the LORD that Elijah had spoken. Jehoram became king in his place in the second year of Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat, king of Judah, because Ahaziah had no son.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Ahaziah that He did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ahab (*AY-hab*) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Sam 8:2

v2 — 2 Kgs 1:16; Matt 10:25; 2 Kgs 8:7-10; Mark 3:22

v3 — 1 Kgs 17:1; Jonah 2:8

v8 — Matt 3:4; Zech 13:4

v10 — Luke 9:54; Dan 3:25; 1 Kgs 18:36-38; Dan 3:22; Heb 12:29

v15 — Isa 51:12; Ezek 2:6

v17 — 2 Kgs 3:1

Chapter 2

Elijah was taken up to heaven in a whirlwind with a chariot of fire, and Elisha took up his mantle and received a double portion of his spirit. Elisha parted the Jordan, healed the waters at Jericho, and cursed the mocking youths of Bethel.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when the LORD would take up Elijah into heaven by a whirlwind, that Elijah went with Elisha from Gilgal.* Now when the LORD was about to take Elijah up to heaven by a whirlwind, Elijah and Elisha were on their way from Gilgal.
- 2 *And Elijah said unto Elisha, Tarry here, I pray thee; for the LORD hath sent me to Bethel. And Elisha said unto him, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. So they went down to Bethel.* Elijah said to Elisha, "Please stay here, for the LORD has sent me as far as Bethel." But Elisha said, "As the LORD lives, and as you yourself live, I will not leave you." So they went down to Bethel.
- 3 *And the sons of the prophets that were at Bethel came forth to Elisha, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the LORD will take away thy master from thy head to day? And he said, Yea, I know it; hold ye your peace.* The sons of the prophets who were in Bethel came out to Elisha and said to him, "Do you know that today the LORD will take away Your master from over You?" And He said, "Yes, I know it; keep quiet."
- 4 *And Elijah said unto him, Elisha, tarry here, I pray thee; for the LORD hath sent me to Jericho. And he said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. So they came to Jericho.* Then Elijah said to him, "Elisha, please stay here, for the LORD has sent me to Jericho." But He said, "As the LORD lives, and as You Yourself live, I will not leave You." So they came to Jericho.
- 5 *And the sons of the prophets that were at Jericho came to Elisha, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the LORD will take away thy master from thy head to day? And he answered, Yea, I know it; hold ye your peace.* The sons of the prophets who were at Jericho drew near to Elisha and said to him, "Do you know that today the LORD will take away Your master from over You?" And He answered, "Yes, I know it; keep quiet."
- 6 *And Elijah said unto him, Tarry, I pray thee, here; for the LORD hath sent me to Jordan. And he said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And they two went on.* Then Elijah said to him, "Please stay here, for the LORD has sent me to the Jordan." But He said, "As the LORD lives, and as You Yourself live, I will not leave You." So the two of them went on.

- 7 *And fifty men of the sons of the prophets went, and stood to view afar off: and they two stood by Jordan.* Fifty men of the sons of the prophets also went and stood at some distance from them, as they both stood by the Jordan.
- 8 *And Elijah took his mantle, and wrapped it together, and smote the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, so that they two went over on dry ground.* Then Elijah took his cloak and rolled it up and struck the water, and the water was parted to the one side and to the other, till the two of them could go over on dry ground.
- 9 *And it came to pass, when they were gone over, that Elijah said unto Elisha, Ask what I shall do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Elisha said, I pray thee, let a double portion of thy spirit be upon me.* When they had crossed, Elijah said to Elisha, "Ask what I shall do for you, before I am taken from you." And Elisha said, "Please let there be a double portion of your spirit on me."
- 10 *And he said, Thou hast asked a hard thing: nevertheless, if thou see me when I am taken from thee, it shall be so unto thee; but if not, it shall not be so.* He said, "You have asked a hard thing; yet, if you see me as I am being taken from you, it shall be so for you, but if you do not see me, it shall not be so."
- 11 *And it came to pass, as they still went on, and talked, that, behold, there appeared a chariot of fire, and horses of fire, and parted them both asunder; and Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven.* As they still went on and talked, a chariot of fire and horses of fire separated the two of them. And Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven.
- 12 *And Elisha saw it, and he cried, My father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the horsemen thereof. And he saw him no more: and he took hold of his own clothes, and rent them in two pieces.* Elisha saw it and he cried, "My father, my father! The chariots of Israel and its horsemen!" And he saw him no more. Then he took hold of his own clothes and tore them in two pieces.
- 13 *He took up also the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and went back, and stood by the bank of Jordan;* He took up the cloak of Elijah that had fallen from him and went back and stood on the bank of the Jordan.

- 14 *And he took the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and smote the waters, and said, Where is the LORD God of Elijah? and when he also had smitten the waters, they parted hither and thither: and Elisha went over.* Then He took the cloak of Elijah that had fallen from him and struck the water, saying, "Where is the LORD, the God of Elijah?" And when he had struck the water, the water was parted to the one side and to the other, and Elisha went over.
- 15 *And when the sons of the prophets which were to view at Jericho saw him, they said, The spirit of Elijah doth rest on Elisha. And they came to meet him, and bowed themselves to the ground before him.* Now when the sons of the prophets who were at Jericho saw him opposite them, they said, "The spirit of Elijah rests on Elisha." And they came to meet him and bowed to the ground before him.
- 16 *And they said unto him, Behold now, there be with thy servants fifty strong men; let them go, we pray thee, and seek thy master: lest peradventure the Spirit of the LORD hath taken him up, and cast him upon some mountain, or into some valley. And he said, Ye shall not send.* They said to Him, "now, there are with Your servants fifty strong men. Please let them go and seek Your master. It may be that the Spirit of the LORD has caught Him up and cast Him on some mountain or into some valley." And He said, "You shall not send."
- 17 *And when they urged him till he was ashamed, he said, Send. They sent therefore fifty men; and they sought three days, but found him not.* But when they urged Him until He was ashamed, He said, "Send." They sent fifty men. And for three days they sought Him but did not find Him.
- 18 *And when they came again to him, (for he tarried at Jericho,) he said unto them, Did I not say unto you, Go not?* They came back to Him while He was staying at Jericho. He said to them, "Did I not say to You, 'Do not go'?"
- 19 *And the men of the city said unto Elisha, Behold, I pray thee, the situation of this city is pleasant, as my lord seeth: but the water is naught, and the ground barren.* Now the men of the city said to Elisha, "the situation of this city is pleasant, as my lord sees, but the water is bad, and the land is unfruitful."

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| 20 | <i>And he said, Bring me a new cruse, and put salt therein. And they brought it to him.</i> | He said, "Bring me a new bowl, and put salt in it." So they brought it to him. |
| 21 | <i>And he went forth unto the spring of the waters, and cast the salt in there, and said, Thus saith the LORD, I have healed these waters; there shall not be from thence any more death or barren land.</i> | Then He went to the spring of water and threw salt in it and said, "Thus says the LORD, I have healed this water; from now on neither death nor miscarriage shall come from it." |
| 22 | <i>So the waters were healed unto this day, according to the saying of Elisha which he spake.</i> | So the water has been healed to this day, according to the word that Elisha spoke. |
| 23 | <i>And he went up from thence unto Bethel: and as he was going up by the way, there came forth little children out of the city, and mocked him, and said unto him, Go up, thou bald head; go up, thou bald head.</i> | He went up from there to Bethel, and while he was going up on the way, some small boys came out of the city and jeered at him, saying, "Go up, you baldhead! Go up, you baldhead!" |
| 24 | <i>And he turned back, and looked on them, and cursed them in the name of the LORD. And there came forth two she bears out of the wood, and tare forty and two children of them.</i> | He turned around, and when He saw them, He cursed them in the name of the LORD. And two she-bears came out of the woods and tore forty-two of the boys. |
| 25 | <i>And he went from thence to mount Carmel, and from thence he returned to Samaria.</i> | From there He went on to Mount Carmel, and from there He returned to Samaria. |

Words in this chapter:

Elisha (*eh-LY-shah*) — Elijah's successor who received a double portion of his spirit — performed many miracles including raising the dead; his name means 'God is salvation.'

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 5:24; Heb 11:5; 1 Kgs 19:16-21
- v3 — 2 Kgs 4:1; 2 Kgs 4:38
- v4 — 2 Kgs 2:2
- v8 — 1 Kgs 19:19; Ex 14:21-22; Josh 3:14-17
- v9 — Num 11:17; Deut 21:17; John 16:7; Acts 20:25-36; Acts 1:8
- v11 — Ps 104:3-4; 2 Kgs 6:17; Heb 1:14; Ps 68:17; Ezek 10:9-22
- v12 — 2 Kgs 13:14
- v14 — John 14:12; Ps 42:10; Ps 115:2
- v19 — Ex 23:26; Deut 28:2-4; Deut 28:11; Deut 28:15-18; Ex 7:19
- v21 — Ex 15:25-26; 2 Kgs 4:41; Lev 2:13; 2 Kgs 6:6; Rev 21:4
- v23 — 2 Chr 36:16
- v24 — Acts 13:9-11; Acts 5:5; Acts 5:9; Hos 13:8; Amos 7:17

Jehoram of Israel — 852–841 BC

Chapter 3

Jehoram of Israel, Jehoshaphat of Judah, and the king of Edom allied against Moab and ran out of water. Elisha provided water and promised victory; Moab was defeated, but the king of Moab sacrificed his son on the wall, and Israel withdrew.

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| 1 | <i>Now Jehoram the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and reigned twelve years.</i> | In the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, Jehoram the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria. He reigned twelve years. |
| 2 | <i>And he wrought evil in the sight of the LORD; but not like his father, and like his mother: for he put away the image of Baal that his father had made.</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, though not like His father and mother, for He put away the pillar of Baal that His father had made. |
| 3 | <i>Nevertheless he cleaved unto the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which made Israel to sin; he departed not therefrom.</i> | Nevertheless, he clung to the sin of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin; he did not depart from it. |
| 4 | <i>And Mesha king of Moab was a sheepmaster, and rendered unto the king of Israel an hundred thousand lambs, and an hundred thousand rams, with the wool.</i> | Now Mesha king of Moab was a sheep breeder. He had to deliver to the king of Israel 100,000 lambs and the wool of 100,000 rams. |

- 5 *But it came to pass, when Ahab was dead, that the king of Moab rebelled against the king of Israel.* But when Ahab died, the king of Moab rebelled against the king of Israel.
- 6 *And king Jehoram went out of Samaria the same time, and numbered all Israel.* So King Jehoram marched out of Samaria at that time and mustered all Israel.
- 7 *And he went and sent to Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, saying, The king of Moab hath rebelled against me: wilt thou go with me against Moab to battle? And he said, I will go up: I am as thou art, my people as thy people, and my horses as thy horses.* He went and sent word to Jehoshaphat king of Judah, "The king of Moab has rebelled against me. Will you go with me to battle against Moab?" And he said, "I will go. I am as you are, my people as your people, my horses as your horses."
- 8 *And he said, Which way shall we go up? And he answered, The way through the wilderness of Edom.* Then he said, "By which way shall we march?" Jehoshaphat answered, "By the way of the wilderness of Edom."
- 9 *So the king of Israel went, and the king of Judah, and the king of Edom: and they fetched a compass of seven days' journey: and there was no water for the host, and for the cattle that followed them.* So the king of Israel, the king of Judah, and the king of Edom set out, and when they had made a circuit of seven days' journey, there was no water for the army or for the animals that followed them.
- 10 *And the king of Israel said, Alas! that the LORD hath called these three kings together, to deliver them into the hand of Moab!* Then the king of Israel said, "Alas! The LORD has called these three kings to give them into the hand of Moab."
- 11 *But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD, that we may enquire of the LORD by him? And one of the king of Israel's servants answered and said, Here is Elisha the son of Shaphat, which poured water on the hands of Elijah.* Jehoshaphat said, "Is there no prophet of the LORD here, through whom we may inquire of the LORD?" Then one of the king of Israel's servants answered, "Elisha the son of Shaphat is here, who poured water on the hands of Elijah."

- 12 *And Jehoshaphat said, The word of the LORD is with him. So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him.* Jehoshaphat said, "The word of the LORD is with Him." So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him.
- 13 *And Elisha said unto the king of Israel, What have I to do with thee? get thee to the prophets of thy father, and to the prophets of thy mother. And the king of Israel said unto him, Nay: for the LORD hath called these three kings together, to deliver them into the hand of Moab.* Elisha said to the king of Israel, "What have I to do with you? Go to the prophets of your father and to the prophets of your mother." But the king of Israel said to him, "No; it is the LORD Who has called these three kings to give them into the hand of Moab."
- 14 *And Elisha said, As the LORD of hosts liveth, before whom I stand, surely, were it not that I regard the presence of Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, I would not look toward thee, nor see thee.* Elisha said, "As the LORD of hosts lives, before whom I stand, were it not that I have regard for Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, I would neither look at you nor see You.
- 15 *But now bring me a minstrel. And it came to pass, when the minstrel played, that the hand of the LORD came upon him.* But now bring me a musician." And when the musician played, the hand of the LORD came upon Him.
- 16 *And he said, Thus saith the LORD, Make this valley full of ditches.* He said, "Thus says the LORD, 'I will make this dry streambed full of pools.'
- 17 *For thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not see wind, neither shall ye see rain; yet that valley shall be filled with water, that ye may drink, both ye, and your cattle, and your beasts.* For thus says the LORD, 'You shall not see wind or rain, but that streambed shall be filled with water, so that You shall drink, You, Your livestock, and Your animals.'
- 18 *And this is but a light thing in the sight of the LORD: he will deliver the Moabites also into your hand.* This is a light thing in the sight of the LORD. He will also give the Moabites into Your hand,

- 19 *And ye shall smite every fenced city, and every choice city, and shall fell every good tree, and stop all wells of water, and mar every good piece of land with stones.* You shall attack every fortified city and every choice city, and shall fell every good tree and stop up all springs of water and ruin every good piece of land with stones."
- 20 *And it came to pass in the morning, when the meat offering was offered, that, behold, there came water by the way of Edom, and the country was filled with water.* The next morning, about the time of offering the sacrifice, water came from the direction of Edom, until the country was filled with water.
- 21 *And when all the Moabites heard that the kings were come up to fight against them, they gathered all that were able to put on armour, and upward, and stood in the border.* When all the Moabites heard that the kings had come up to fight against them, all who were able to put on armor, from the youngest to the oldest, were called out and were drawn up at the border.
- 22 *And they rose up early in the morning, and the sun shone upon the water, and the Moabites saw the water on the other side as red as blood:* When they rose early in the morning and the sun shone on the water, the Moabites saw the water opposite them as red as blood.
- 23 *And they said, This is blood: the kings are surely slain, and they have smitten one another: now therefore, Moab, to the spoil.* They said, "This is blood; the kings have surely fought together and struck one another down. Now then, Moab, to the spoil!"
- 24 *And when they came to the camp of Israel, the Israelites rose up and smote the Moabites, so that they fled before them: but they went forward smiting the Moabites, even in their country.* But when they came to the camp of Israel, the Israelites rose and struck the Moabites, till they fled before them. And they went forward, striking the Moabites as they fled.

- 25 *And they beat down the cities, and on every good piece of land cast every man his stone, and filled it; and they stopped all the wells of water, and felled all the good trees: only in Kirharaseth left they the stones thereof; howbeit the slingers went about it, and smote it.* They overthrew the cities, and every man threw a stone on every good piece of land and filled it. They stopped every spring of water and felled every good tree, till only its stones were left in Kir-hareseth, and the slingers surrounded and struck it.
- 26 *And when the king of Moab saw that the battle was too sore for him, he took with him seven hundred men that drew swords, to break through even unto the king of Edom: but they could not.* When the king of Moab saw that the battle was going against him, he took with him 700 swordsmen to break through, opposite the king of Edom. But they could not.
- 27 *Then he took his eldest son that should have reigned in his stead, and offered him for a burnt offering upon the wall. And there was great indignation against Israel: and they departed from him, and returned to their own land.* Then he took his oldest son who was to reign in his place and offered him for a burnt offering on the wall. And there came great wrath against Israel. And they withdrew from him and returned to their own land.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Kgs 1:17

v2 — 2 Kgs 10:18

v3 — 1 Kgs 14:16

v5 — 2 Kgs 1:1

v7 — 1 Kgs 22:4

v11 — 1 Kgs 22:7; 1 Kgs 19:21

v14 — 2 Kgs 5:16

v15 — 1 Sam 16:23; Eph 5:18-19; 1 Sam 10:5; Ezek 1:3; 1 Kgs 18:46

v17 — Ps 107:35; Isa 41:17-18; Isa 43:19-20; Isa 48:21; Ps 84:6

v18 — Luke 1:37; Jer 32:27; Jer 32:17; 2 Kgs 20:10; Isa 49:6

v25 — Isa 16:7; Jer 48:31; Jer 48:36; 2 Kgs 3:19

v27 — Mic 6:7; Deut 12:31; Judg 11:31; Ezek 16:20; Amos 2:1

Chapter 4

Elisha multiplied a widow's oil to pay her debts and promised a son to the Shunammite woman. When the child later died, Elisha raised him to life; he also purified poisoned stew and multiplied twenty loaves to feed a hundred men.

- 1 *Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets unto Elisha, saying, Thy servant my husband is dead; and thou knowest that thy servant did fear the LORD: and the creditor is come to take unto him my two sons to be bondmen.* Now the wife of one of the sons of the prophets cried to Elisha, "Your servant my husband is dead, and you know that your servant feared the LORD, but the creditor has come to take my two children to be his slaves."
- 2 *And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.* Elisha said to her, "What shall I do for you? Tell me; what do you have in the house?" And she said, "Your servant has nothing in the house except a jar of oil."
- 3 *Then he said, Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, even empty vessels; borrow not a few.* Then he said, "Go outside, borrow vessels from all your neighbors, empty vessels and not too few."
- 4 *And when thou art come in, thou shalt shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and shalt pour out into all those vessels, and thou shalt set aside that which is full.* Then go in and shut the door behind yourself and your sons and pour into all these vessels. And when one is full, set it aside."
- 5 *So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons, who brought the vessels to her; and she poured out.* So she went from him and shut the door behind herself and her sons. And as she poured they brought the vessels to her.

- 6 *And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son, Bring me yet a vessel. And he said unto her, There is not a vessel more. And the oil stayed.* When the vessels were full, she said to her son, "Bring me another vessel." And he said to her, "There is not another." Then the oil stopped flowing.
- 7 *Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy children of the rest.* She came and told the man of God. He said, "Go, sell the oil and pay your debts, and you and your sons can live on the rest."
- 8 *And it fell on a day, that Elisha passed to Shunem, where was a great woman; and she constrained him to eat bread. And so it was, that as oft as he passed by, he turned in thither to eat bread.* One day Elisha went on to Shunem, where a wealthy woman lived, who urged him to eat some food. So whenever he passed that way, he would turn in there to eat food.
- 9 *And she said unto her husband, Behold now, I perceive that this is an holy man of God, which passeth by us continually.* She said to her husband, "now, I know that this is a holy man of God Who is continually passing our way."
- 10 *Let us make a little chamber, I pray thee, on the wall; and let us set for him there a bed, and a table, and a stool, and a candlestick: and it shall be, when he cometh to us, that he shall turn in thither.* Let us make a small room on the roof with walls and put there for him a bed, a table, a chair, and a lamp, so that whenever he comes to us, he can go in there."
- 11 *And it fell on a day, that he came thither, and he turned into the chamber, and lay there.* One day he came there. He turned into the chamber and rested there.
- 12 *And he said to Gehazi his servant, Call this Shunammite. And when he had called her, she stood before him.* He said to Gehazi his servant, "Call this Shunammite." When he had called her, she stood before him.

- 13 *And he said unto him, Say now unto her, Behold, thou hast been careful for us with all this care; what is to be done for thee? wouldest thou be spoken for to the king, or to the captain of the host? And she answered, I dwell among mine own people.* He said to him, "Say now to her, 'See, you have taken all this trouble for us; what is to be done for you? Would you have a word spoken on your behalf to the king or to the commander of the army?'" She answered, "I dwell among my own people."
- 14 *And he said, What then is to be done for her? And Gehazi answered, Verily she hath no child, and her husband is old.* He said, "What then is to be done for her?" Gehazi answered, "Well, she has no son. Her husband is old."
- 15 *And he said, Call her. And when he had called her, she stood in the door.* He said, "Call her." And when he had called her, she stood in the doorway.
- 16 *And he said, About this season, according to the time of life, thou shalt embrace a son. And she said, Nay, my lord, thou man of God, do not lie unto thine handmaid.* He said, "At this season, about this time next year, you shall embrace a son." And she said, "No, my lord, O man of God; do not lie to your servant."
- 17 *And the woman conceived, and bare a son at that season that Elisha had said unto her, according to the time of life.* But the woman conceived. She bore a son at that season, according to the time of life, as Elisha had said to her.
- 18 *And when the child was grown, it fell on a day, that he went out to his father to the reapers.* When the child had grown, he went out one day to his father among the reapers.
- 19 *And he said unto his father, My head, my head. And he said to a lad, Carry him to his mother.* He said to his father, "Oh, my head, my head!" The father said to his servant, "Carry him to his mother."
- 20 *And when he had taken him, and brought him to his mother, he sat on her knees till noon, and then died.* When he had lifted him and brought him to his mother, the child sat on her lap till noon, and then he died.
- 21 *And she went up, and laid him on the bed of the man of God, and shut the door upon him, and went out.* She went up and laid him on the bed of the man of God and shut the door behind Him and went out.

- 22 *And she called unto her husband, and said, Send me, I pray thee, one of the young men, and one of the asses, that I may run to the man of God, and come again.* Then she called to her husband and said, "Send me one of the servants and one of the donkeys, that I may quickly go to the man of God and come back again."
- 23 *And he said, Wherefore wilt thou go to him to day? it is neither new moon, nor sabbath. And she said, It shall be well.* He said, "Why will you go to him today? It is neither new moon nor Sabbath." She said, "All is well."
- 24 *Then she saddled an ass, and said to her servant, Drive, and go forward; slack not thy riding for me, except I bid thee.* Then she saddled the donkey. She said to her servant, "Urge the animal on; do not slacken the pace for me unless I tell you."
- 25 *So she went and came unto the man of God to mount Carmel. And it came to pass, when the man of God saw her afar off, that he said to Gehazi his servant, Behold, yonder is that Shunammite:* So she set out and came to the man of God at Mount Carmel. When the man of God saw her coming, He said to Gehazi His servant, "Look, there is the Shunammite."
- 26 *Run now, I pray thee, to meet her, and say unto her, Is it well with thee? is it well with thy husband? is it well with the child? And she answered, It is well.* Run at once to meet her and say to her, 'Is all well with you? Is all well with your husband? Is all well with the child?'" And she answered, "All is well."
- 27 *And when she came to the man of God to the hill, she caught him by the feet: but Gehazi came near to thrust her away. And the man of God said, Let her alone; for her soul is vexed within her: and the LORD hath hid it from me, and hath not told me.* When she came to the mountain to the man of God, she caught hold of His feet. And Gehazi came to push her away. But the man of God said, "Leave her alone, for she is in bitter distress. The LORD has hidden it from me and has not told me."
- 28 *Then she said, Did I desire a son of my lord? did I not say, Do not deceive me?* Then she said, "Did I ask my lord for a son? Did I not say, 'Do not deceive me'?"

- 29 *Then he said to Gehazi, Gird up thy loins, and take my staff in thine hand, and go thy way: if thou meet any man, salute him not; and if any salute thee, answer him not again: and lay my staff upon the face of the child.* He said to Gehazi, "Tie up Your garment and take my staff in Your hand and go. If You meet anyone, do not greet him, and if anyone greets you, do not reply. And lay my staff on the face of the child."
- 30 *And the mother of the child said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And he arose, and followed her.* Then the mother of the child said, "As the LORD lives and as You Yourself live, I will not leave You." So He arose and followed her.
- 31 *And Gehazi passed on before them, and laid the staff upon the face of the child; but there was neither voice, nor hearing. Wherefore he went again to meet him, and told him, saying, The child is not awaked.* Gehazi went on ahead and laid the staff on the face of the child, but there was no sound or sign of life. Therefore He returned to meet Him and told Him, "The child has not awakened."
- 32 *And when Elisha was come into the house, behold, the child was dead, and laid upon his bed.* When Elisha came into the house, he saw the child lying dead on his bed.
- 33 *He went in therefore, and shut the door upon them twain, and prayed unto the LORD.* So He went in and shut the door behind the two of them and prayed to the LORD.
- 34 *And he went up, and lay upon the child, and put his mouth upon his mouth, and his eyes upon his eyes, and his hands upon his hands: and he stretched himself upon the child; and the flesh of the child waxed warm.* Then He got up and lay on the child, putting his mouth on his mouth, his eyes on His eyes. His hands on His hands. And as He stretched Himself upon Him, the flesh of the child became warm.
- 35 *Then he returned, and walked in the house to and fro; and went up, and stretched himself upon him: and the child sneezed seven times, and the child opened his eyes.* Then He got up again and walked once back and forth in the house, and went up and stretched Himself upon Him. The child sneezed seven times, and the child opened his eyes.

- 36 *And he called Gehazi, and said, Call this Shunammite. So he called her. And when she was come in unto him, he said, Take up thy son.* Then He summoned Gehazi and said, "Call this Shunammite." So He called her. And when she came to Him, He said, "Pick up Your son."
- 37 *Then she went in, and fell at his feet, and bowed herself to the ground, and took up her son, and went out.* She came and fell at His feet, bowing to the ground. Then she picked up her son and went out.
- 38 *And Elisha came again to Gilgal: and there was a dearth in the land; and the sons of the prophets were sitting before him: and he said unto his servant, Set on the great pot, and seethe pottage for the sons of the prophets.* Elisha came again to Gilgal when there was a famine in the land. And as the sons of the prophets were sitting before him, he said to his servant, "Set on the large pot, and boil stew for the sons of the prophets."
- 39 *And one went out into the field to gather herbs, and found a wild vine, and gathered thereof wild gourds his lap full, and came and shred them into the pot of pottage: for they knew them not.* One of them went out into the field to gather herbs, and found a wild vine and gathered from it his lap full of wild gourds, and came and cut them up into the pot of stew, not knowing what they were.
- 40 *So they poured out for the men to eat. And it came to pass, as they were eating of the pottage, that they cried out, and said, O thou man of God, there is death in the pot. And they could not eat thereof.* They poured out some for the men to eat. But as they were eating the stew, they cried out, "O man of God, there is death in the pot!" And they could not eat it.
- 41 *But he said, Then bring meal. And he cast it into the pot; and he said, Pour out for the people, that they may eat. And there was no harm in the pot.* He said, "Then bring flour." And he threw it into the pot and said, "Pour some out for the men, that they may eat." And there was no harm in the pot.

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| <p>42 <i>And there came a man from Baalshalisha, and brought the man of God bread of the firstfruits, twenty loaves of barley, and full ears of corn in the husk thereof. And he said, Give unto the people, that they may eat.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And his servitor said, What, should I set this before an hundred men? He said again, Give the people, that they may eat: for thus saith the LORD, They shall eat, and shall leave thereof.</i></p> <p>44 <i>So he set it before them, and they did eat, and left thereof, according to the word of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>A man came from Baal-shalishah, bringing the man of God bread of the firstfruits, twenty loaves of barley and fresh ears of grain in his sack. And Elisha said, "Give to the men, that they may eat."</p> <p>But His servant said, "How can I set this before a hundred men?" So He repeated, "Give them to the men, that they may eat, for thus says the LORD, 'They shall eat and have some left.' "</p> <p>So He set it before them. And they ate and had some left, according to the word of the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

pottage — A thick stew or soup — Esau sold his birthright for a bowl of red pottage (lentil stew).

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 18:25; 2 Kgs 2:3; Neh 5:2-5; Ps 147:11
v2 — 1 Kgs 17:12; Jas 2:5
v8 — Josh 19:18; Job 32:9; 1 Kgs 1:3; Gen 19:3; Luke 24:29
v10 — Rom 12:13; Matt 10:41-42; Matt 25:40
v13 — 2 Tim 1:16-18; Phil 4:18-19; Heb 6:10; 1 Tim 6:6-8; 1 Thess 5:12-13
v14 — Gen 15:2-3; 1 Sam 1:8; Luke 1:7; Gen 18:10-14; Gen 25:21
v16 — Gen 18:10; Luke 1:13; 2 Kgs 4:28; Gen 18:12-15; Gen 17:21
v17 — Luke 1:36; Gen 21:1; Ps 113:9
v29 — 2 Kgs 2:14; 1 Kgs 18:46; Ex 14:16; 2 Kgs 9:1; Luke 10:4
v33 — Matt 6:6; 2 Kgs 4:4; Acts 9:40
v38 — 2 Kgs 2:3; 2 Kgs 8:1; 2 Kgs 2:1

v43 — Luke 9:13; Matt 14:20; John 6:9

Chapter 5

Naaman, commander of the Syrian army, came to Elisha to be healed of leprosy and was told to wash seven times in the Jordan. Naaman obeyed and was cleansed; Elisha's servant Gehazi deceitfully obtained gifts from Naaman and was struck with his leprosy.

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| <p>1 <i>Now Naaman, captain of the host of the king of Syria, was a great man with his master, and honourable, because by him the LORD had given deliverance unto Syria: he was also a mighty man in valour, but he was a leper.</i></p> | <p>Naaman, commander of the army of the king of Syria, was a great man with his master and in high favor, because by Him the LORD had given victory to Syria. He was a mighty man of valor. But He was a leper.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Naaman** (NAY-ah-man) — "pleasant" — *The commander of the Syrian army, a mighty warrior but a leper. At the direction of a captive Israelite girl, he came to Elisha and was healed by washing seven times in the Jordan. Jesus cited his healing as an example of God's grace to Gentiles (Luke 4:27).*

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| <p>2 <i>And the Syrians had gone out by companies, and had brought away captive out of the land of Israel a little maid; and she waited on Naaman's wife.</i></p> | <p>Now the Syrians on one of their raids had carried off a little girl from the land of Israel. She worked in the service of Naaman's wife.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And she said unto her mistress, Would God my lord were with the prophet that is in Samaria! for he would recover him of his leprosy.</i></p> | <p>She said to her mistress, "Would that my lord were with the prophet who is in Samaria! He would cure him of his leprosy."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And one went in, and told his lord, saying, Thus and thus said the maid that is of the land of Israel.</i></p> | <p>So Naaman went in and told his lord, "Thus and so spoke the girl from the land of Israel."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And the king of Syria said, Go to, go, and I will send a letter unto the king of Israel. And he departed, and took with him ten talents of silver, and six thousand pieces of gold, and ten changes of raiment.</i></p> | <p>The king of Syria said, "Go now. I will send a letter to the king of Israel." So he went, taking with him ten talents of silver, six thousand shekels of gold, and ten changes of clothing.</p> |

- 6 *And he brought the letter to the king of Israel, saying, Now when this letter is come unto thee, behold, I have therewith sent Naaman my servant to thee, that thou mayest recover him of his leprosy.* He brought the letter to the king of Israel, which read, "When this letter reaches you, know that I have sent to you Naaman my servant, that you may cure him of his leprosy."
- 7 *And it came to pass, when the king of Israel had read the letter, that he rent his clothes, and said, Am I God, to kill and to make alive, that this man doth send unto me to recover a man of his leprosy? wherefore consider, I pray you, and see how he seeketh a quarrel against me.* When the king of Israel read the letter, he tore his clothes and said, "Am I God, to kill and to make alive, that this man sends word to me to cure a man of his leprosy? Only consider, and see how he is seeking a quarrel with me."
- 8 *And it was so, when Elisha the man of God had heard that the king of Israel had rent his clothes, that he sent to the king, saying, Wherefore hast thou rent thy clothes? let him come now to me, and he shall know that there is a prophet in Israel.* But when Elisha the man of God heard that the king of Israel had torn his clothes, he sent to the king, saying, "Why have you torn your clothes? Let him come now to me, that he may know there is a prophet in Israel."
- 9 *So Naaman came with his horses and with his chariot, and stood at the door of the house of Elisha.* So Naaman came with his horses and chariots and stood at the door of Elisha's house.
- 10 *And Elisha sent a messenger unto him, saying, Go and wash in Jordan seven times, and thy flesh shall come again to thee, and thou shalt be clean.* Elisha sent a messenger to him, saying, "Go and wash in the Jordan seven times, and your flesh shall be restored, and you shall be clean."
- 11 *But Naaman was wroth, and went away, and said, Behold, I thought, He will surely come out to me, and stand, and call on the name of the LORD his God, and strike his hand over the place, and recover the leper.* But Naaman was angry and went away, saying, "I thought that He would surely come out to me and stand and call upon the name of the LORD His God, and wave His hand over the place and cure the leper."

- 12 *Are not Abana and Pharpar, rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? may I not wash in them, and be clean? So he turned and went away in a rage.* Are not Abana and Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? Could I not wash in them and be clean?" So He turned and went away in a rage.
- 13 *And his servants came near, and spake unto him, and said, My father, if the prophet had bid thee do some great thing, wouldest thou not have done it? how much rather then, when he saith to thee, Wash, and be clean?* But his servants came near and said to him, "My father, it is a great word the prophet has spoken to you; will you not do it? Has he actually said to you, 'Wash, and be clean'?"
- 14 *Then went he down, and dipped himself seven times in Jordan, according to the saying of the man of God: and his flesh came again like unto the flesh of a little child, and he was clean.* So he went down and dipped himself seven times in the Jordan, according to the word of the man of God. His flesh was restored like the flesh of a little child. He was clean.
- 15 *And he returned to the man of God, he and all his company, and came, and stood before him: and he said, Behold, now I know that there is no God in all the earth, but in Israel: now therefore, I pray thee, take a blessing of thy servant.* Then he returned to the man of God, He and all His company. He came and stood before Him. And He said, "I know that there is no God in all the earth but in Israel; so accept now a present from your servant."
- 16 *But he said, As the LORD liveth, before whom I stand, I will receive none. And he urged him to take it; but he refused.* But He said, "As the LORD lives, before whom I stand, I will receive none." And He urged Him to take it. But He refused.
- 17 *And Naaman said, Shall there not then, I pray thee, be given to thy servant two mules' burden of earth? for thy servant will henceforth offer neither burnt offering nor sacrifice unto other gods, but unto the LORD.* Then Naaman said, "If not, please let there be given to Your servant two mule-loads of earth, for from now on Your servant will not offer burnt offering or sacrifice to any god but the LORD.

- 18 *In this thing the LORD pardon thy servant, that when my master goeth into the house of Rimmon to worship there, and he leaneth on my hand, and I bow myself in the house of Rimmon: when I bow down myself in the house of Rimmon, the LORD pardon thy servant in this thing.* In this matter may the LORD pardon Your servant: when my master goes into the house of Rimmon to worship there, leaning on my arm. I bow myself in the house of Rimmon, when I bow myself in the house of Rimmon, the LORD pardon Your servant in this matter."
- 19 *And he said unto him, Go in peace. So he departed from him a little way.* He said to Him, "Go in peace." So He departed from Him a little way.
- 20 *But Gehazi, the servant of Elisha the man of God, said, Behold, my master hath spared Naaman this Syrian, in not receiving at his hands that which he brought: but, as the LORD liveth, I will run after him, and take somewhat of him.* But Gehazi, the servant of Elisha the man of God, said, "See, my master has spared this Naaman the Syrian, in not accepting from His hand what He brought. As the LORD lives, I will run after Him and get something from Him."
- 21 *So Gehazi followed after Naaman. And when Naaman saw him running after him, he lighted down from the chariot to meet him, and said, Is all well?* So Gehazi followed Naaman. And when Naaman saw someone running after him, he got down from the chariot to meet Him and said, "Is all well?"
- 22 *And he said, All is well. My master hath sent me, saying, Behold, even now there be come to me from mount Ephraim two young men of the sons of the prophets: give them, I pray thee, a talent of silver, and two changes of garments.* He said, "All is well. My master has sent me to say, 'There have just now come to me from the hill country of Ephraim two young men of the sons of the prophets. Please give them a talent of silver and two changes of clothing.' "

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| <p>23 <i>And Naaman said, Be content, take two talents. And he urged him, and bound two talents of silver in two bags, with two changes of garments, and laid them upon two of his servants; and they bare them before him.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And when he came to the tower, he took them from their hand, and bestowed them in the house: and he let the men go, and they departed.</i></p> <p>25 <i>But he went in, and stood before his master. And Elisha said unto him, Whence comest thou, Gehazi? And he said, Thy servant went no whither.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And he said unto him, Went not mine heart with thee, when the man turned again from his chariot to meet thee? Is it a time to receive money, and to receive garments, and oliveyards, and vineyards, and sheep, and oxen, and menservants, and maidservants?</i></p> <p>27 <i>The leprosy therefore of Naaman shall cleave unto thee, and unto thy seed for ever. And he went out from his presence a leper as white as snow.</i></p> | <p>Naaman said, "Be pleased to accept two talents." And He urged Him and tied up two talents of silver in two bags, with two changes of clothing, and laid them on two of His servants. And they carried them before Gehazi.</p> <p>When He came to the hill, He took them from their hand and put them in the house. He sent the men away. They departed.</p> <p>He went in and stood before his master, and Elisha said to him, "Where have you been, Gehazi?" And he said, "Your servant went nowhere."</p> <p>But he said to him, "Did not my heart go when the man turned from his chariot to meet you? Was it a time to accept money and garments, olive orchards and vineyards, sheep and oxen, male servants and female servants?</p> <p>Therefore the leprosy of Naaman shall cling to you and to your descendants forever." So he went out from his presence a leper, like snow.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 4:27; Rom 15:18; Prov 21:31; Esth 9:4; Esth 10:3
v2 — 2 Kgs 6:23
v5 — Judg 14:12
v7 — 1 Sam 2:6; Gen 30:2; 1 Kgs 20:7; Deut 32:39

v10 — John 9:7; 1 Cor 6:11; Lev 14:7; Josh 6:4; Matt 15:23-26

v13 — 2 Kgs 6:21; 2 Kgs 2:12; 2 Kgs 13:14; Rev 7:14

v14 — Job 33:25; Luke 4:27; Luke 5:13; Zech 14:8; 2 Kgs 5:10

v15 — Dan 2:47; Dan 6:26-27

v18 — 2 Kgs 7:2; 2 Kgs 7:17

v19 — 1 Sam 1:17

v20 — 2 Kgs 4:12

v26 — Col 2:5; 1 Cor 5:3; 2 Kgs 6:12; Acts 20:35

Chapter 6

Elisha made an iron axe head float and repeatedly revealed the Syrian king's battle plans to the king of Israel. The Syrians besieged Samaria, causing a terrible famine; Elisha prophesied that food would be cheap by the next day.

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| <p>1 <i>And the sons of the prophets said unto Elisha, Behold now, the place where we dwell with thee is too strait for us.</i></p> | Now the sons of the prophets said to Elisha, "See, the place where we dwell under your charge is too small for us. |
| <p>2 <i>Let us go, we pray thee, unto Jordan, and take thence every man a beam, and let us make us a place there, where we may dwell. And he answered, Go ye.</i></p> | Let us go to the Jordan and each of us get there a log, and let us make a place for us to dwell there." And he answered, "Go." |
| <p>3 <i>And one said, Be content, I pray thee, and go with thy servants. And he answered, I will go.</i></p> | Then one of them said, "Be pleased to go with your servants." And he answered, "I will go." |
| <p>4 <i>So he went with them. And when they came to Jordan, they cut down wood.</i></p> | So he went with them. And when they came to the Jordan, they cut down trees. |
| <p>5 <i>But as one was felling a beam, the axe head fell into the water: and he cried, and said, Alas, master! for it was borrowed.</i></p> | But as one was felling a log, his axe head fell into the water. He cried out, "Alas, my master! It was borrowed." |
| <p>6 <i>And the man of God said, Where fell it? And he shewed him the place. And he cut down a stick, and cast it in thither; and the iron did swim.</i></p> | Then the man of God said, "Where did it fall?" When He showed Him the place, He cut off a stick and threw it in there and made the iron float. |

- 7 *Therefore said he, Take it up to thee. And he put out his hand, and took it.* He said, "Take it up." So he reached out his hand and took it.
- 8 *Then the king of Syria warred against Israel, and took counsel with his servants, saying, In such and such a place shall be my camp.* Once when the king of Syria was warring against Israel, he took counsel with his servants, saying, "At such and such a place shall be my camp."
- 9 *And the man of God sent unto the king of Israel, saying, Beware that thou pass not such a place; for thither the Syrians are come down.* But the man of God sent word to the king of Israel, "Beware that you do not pass this place, for the Syrians are going down there."
- 10 *And the king of Israel sent to the place which the man of God told him and warned him of, and saved himself there, not once nor twice.* The king of Israel sent to the place about which the man of God told him. Thus He used to warn Him, so that He saved himself there more than once or twice.
- 11 *Therefore the heart of the king of Syria was sore troubled for this thing; and he called his servants, and said unto them, Will ye not shew me which of us is for the king of Israel?* The mind of the king of Syria was greatly troubled because of this thing. He called his servants and said to them, "Will you not show me who of us is for the king of Israel?"
- 12 *And one of his servants said, None, my lord, O king: but Elisha, the prophet that is in Israel, telleth the king of Israel the words that thou speakest in thy bedchamber.* One of his servants said, "None, my lord, O king; but Elisha, the prophet who is in Israel, tells the king of Israel the words that you speak in your bedroom."
- 13 *And he said, Go and spy where he is, that I may send and fetch him. And it was told him, saying, Behold, he is in Dothan.* He said, "Go and see where he is, that I may send and seize him." It was told him, "He is in Dothan."
- 14 *Therefore sent he thither horses, and chariots, and a great host: and they came by night, and compassed the city about.* So he sent there horses and chariots and a great army. They came by night and surrounded the city.

- 15 *And when the servant of the man of God was risen early, and gone forth, behold, an host compassed the city both with horses and chariots. And his servant said unto him, Alas, my master! how shall we do?* When the servant of the man of God rose early in the morning and went out, an army with horses and chariots was all around the city. And the servant said, "Alas, my master! What shall we do?"
- 16 *And he answered, Fear not: for they that be with us are more than they that be with them.* He said, "Do not be afraid, for those who are with us are more than those who are with them."
- 17 *And Elisha prayed, and said, LORD, I pray thee, open his eyes, that he may see. And the LORD opened the eyes of the young man; and he saw: and, behold, the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire round about Elisha.* Then Elisha prayed and said, "O LORD, please open His eyes that He may see." So the LORD opened the eyes of the young man. He saw, and the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire all around Elisha.
- 18 *And when they came down to him, Elisha prayed unto the LORD, and said, Smite this people, I pray thee, with blindness. And he smote them with blindness according to the word of Elisha.* When the Syrians came down against Him, Elisha prayed to the LORD and said, "Please strike this people with blindness." So He struck them with blindness according to the prayer of Elisha.
- 19 *And Elisha said unto them, This is not the way, neither is this the city: follow me, and I will bring you to the man whom ye seek. But he led them to Samaria.* Elisha said to them, "This is not the way, and this is not the city. Follow me. I will bring you to the man whom you seek." And he led them to Samaria.
- 20 *And it came to pass, when they were come into Samaria, that Elisha said, LORD, open the eyes of these men, that they may see. And the LORD opened their eyes, and they saw; and, behold, they were in the midst of Samaria.* As soon as they entered Samaria, Elisha said, "O LORD, open the eyes of these men, that they may see." So the LORD opened their eyes and they saw. They were in the midst of Samaria.

- 21 *And the king of Israel said unto Elisha, when he saw them, My father, shall I smite them? shall I smite them?* As soon as the king of Israel saw them, he said to Elisha, "My father, shall I strike them down? Shall I strike them down?"
- 22 *And he answered, Thou shalt not smite them: wouldest thou smite those whom thou hast taken captive with thy sword and with thy bow? set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, and go to their master.* He answered, "You shall not strike them down. Would you strike down those whom you have taken captive with your sword and with your bow? Set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink and go to their master."
- 23 *And he prepared great provision for them: and when they had eaten and drunk, he sent them away, and they went to their master. So the bands of Syria came no more into the land of Israel.* So he prepared for them a great feast, and when they had eaten and drunk, he sent them away. They went to their master. And the Syrians did not come again on raids into the land of Israel.
- 24 *And it came to pass after this, that Benhadad king of Syria gathered all his host, and went up, and besieged Samaria.* Afterward Ben-hadad king of Syria mustered his entire army and went up and besieged Samaria.
- 25 *And there was a great famine in Samaria: and, behold, they besieged it, until an ass's head was sold for fourscore pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a cab of dove's dung for five pieces of silver.* There was a great famine in Samaria, as they besieged it, until a donkey's head was sold for eighty shekels of silver, and the fourth part of a kab of dove's dung for five shekels of silver.
- 26 *And as the king of Israel was passing by upon the wall, there cried a woman unto him, saying, Help, my lord, O king.* Now as the king of Israel was passing by on the wall, a woman cried out to him, "Help, my lord, O king!"
- 27 *And he said, If the LORD do not help thee, whence shall I help thee? out of the barnfloor, or out of the winepress?* He said, "If the LORD will not help You, how shall I help You? From the threshing floor, or from the winepress?"

- 28 *And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, This woman said unto me, Give thy son, that we may eat him to day, and we will eat my son to morrow.* The king asked her, "What is your trouble?" She answered, "This woman said to me, 'Give your son, that we may eat him today. We will eat my son tomorrow.'
- 29 *So we boiled my son, and did eat him: and I said unto her on the next day, Give thy son, that we may eat him: and she hath hid her son.* So we boiled my son and ate him. And on the next day I said to her, 'Give your son, that we may eat him.' But she has hidden her son."
- 30 *And it came to pass, when the king heard the words of the woman, that he rent his clothes; and he passed by upon the wall, and the people looked, and, behold, he had sackcloth within upon his flesh.* When the king heard the words of the woman, he tore his clothes—now he was passing by on the wall—and the people looked. He had sackcloth beneath on his body—
- 31 *Then he said, God do so and more also to me, if the head of Elisha the son of Shaphat shall stand on him this day.* He said, "May God do so to me and more also, if the head of Elisha the son of Shaphat remains on his shoulders today."
- 32 *But Elisha sat in his house, and the elders sat with him; and the king sent a man from before him: but ere the messenger came to him, he said to the elders, See ye how this son of a murderer hath sent to take away mine head? look, when the messenger cometh, shut the door, and hold him fast at the door: is not the sound of his master's feet behind him?* Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. Now the king had dispatched a man from his presence. But before the messenger arrived, Elisha said to the elders, "Do you see how this son of a murderer has sent to take off my head? Look, when the messenger comes, shut the door and hold the door fast against him. Is not the sound of his master's feet behind him?"
- 33 *And while he yet talked with them, behold, the messenger came down unto him: and he said, Behold, this evil is of the LORD; what should I wait for the LORD any longer?* While He was still talking with them, the messenger came down to him and said, "This trouble is from the LORD! Why should I wait for the LORD any longer?"

Words in this chapter:

Elisha (*eh-LY-shah*) — Elijah's successor who received a double portion of his spirit — performed many miracles including raising the dead; his name means 'God is salvation.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Kgs 2:3; Isa 54:2-3; 1 Kgs 20:35; Josh 17:14; 2 Kgs 4:1

v6 — 2 Kgs 2:21

v12 — Dan 2:28-30; Amos 3:7; Eccl 10:20; Dan 2:22-23; 2 Kgs 6:9-10

v13 — Gen 37:17

v15 — Matt 8:26

v16 — Rom 8:31; Isa 41:10-14; 1 John 4:4; 2 Chr 32:7-8; Acts 18:9-10

v17 — Ps 34:7; Ps 68:17; Zech 6:1-7; Heb 1:14; Acts 26:18

v18 — Acts 13:11; John 12:40

v21 — 2 Kgs 5:13

v23 — 2 Kgs 5:2

v24 — 1 Kgs 20:1

v32 — Ezek 14:1; 1 Kgs 18:4; Ezek 20:1; Ezek 8:1

Chapter 7

Four lepers discovered the Syrian camp abandoned, for the LORD had caused the Syrians to hear the sound of a great army and flee. The lepers reported the news, and the people plundered the camp; food was sold cheaply as Elisha had prophesied.

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| <p>¹ Then Elisha said, Hear ye the word of the LORD; Thus saith the LORD, To morrow about this time shall a measure of fine flour be sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, in the gate of Samaria.</p> | <p>But Elisha said, "Hear the word of the LORD: thus says the LORD, Tomorrow about this time a measure of fine flour shall be sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, at the gate of Samaria."</p> |
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- 2 *Then a lord on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God, and said, Behold, if the LORD would make windows in heaven, might this thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.* Then the captain on whose hand the king leaned said to the man of God, "If the LORD Himself should make windows in heaven, could this thing be?" But He said, "You shall see it with Your own eyes, but You shall not eat of it."
- 3 *And there were four leprous men at the entering in of the gate: and they said one to another, Why sit we here until we die?* Now there were four men who were lepers at the entrance to the gate. They said to one another, "Why are we sitting here until we die?"
- 4 *If we say, We will enter into the city, then the famine is in the city, and we shall die there: and if we sit still here, we die also. Now therefore come, and let us fall unto the host of the Syrians: if they save us alive, we shall live; and if they kill us, we shall but die.* If we say, 'Let us enter the city,' the famine is in the city. We shall die there. And if we sit here, we die also. So now come, let us go over to the camp of the Syrians. If they spare our lives we shall live, and if they kill us we shall but die."
- 5 *And they rose up in the twilight, to go unto the camp of the Syrians: and when they were come to the uttermost part of the camp of Syria, behold, there was no man there.* So they arose at twilight to go to the camp of the Syrians. But when they came to the edge of the Syrian camp, there was no one there.
- 6 *For the LORD had made the host of the Syrians to hear a noise of chariots, and a noise of horses, even the noise of a great host: and they said one to another, Lo, the king of Israel hath hired against us the kings of the Hittites, and the kings of the Egyptians, to come upon us.* For the LORD had made the army of the Syrians hear the sound of chariots and of horses, the sound of a great army, so that they said to one another, "the king of Israel has hired against us the kings of the Hittites and the kings of Egypt to come against us."
- 7 *Wherefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, and their horses, and their asses, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life.* So they fled away in the twilight and abandoned their tents, their horses. Their donkeys, leaving the camp as it was, and fled for their lives.

- 8 *And when these lepers came to the uttermost part of the camp, they went into one tent, and did eat and drink, and carried thence silver, and gold, and raiment, and went and hid it; and came again, and entered into another tent, and carried thence also, and went and hid it.* When these lepers came to the edge of the camp, they went into a tent and ate and drank and carried off silver and gold and clothing and went and hid them. Then they came back and entered another tent and carried off things from it and went and hid them.
- 9 *Then they said one to another, We do not well: this day is a day of good tidings, and we hold our peace: if we tarry till the morning light, some mischief will come upon us: now therefore come, that we may go and tell the king's household.* Then they said to one another, "We are not doing right. This day is a day of good news. If we are silent and wait until the morning light, punishment will overtake us. Now therefore come; let us go and tell the king's household."
- 10 *So they came and called unto the porter of the city: and they told them, saying, We came to the camp of the Syrians, and, behold, there was no man there, neither voice of man, but horses tied, and asses tied, and the tents as they were.* So they came and called to the gatekeepers of the city and told them, "We came to the camp of the Syrians, and there was no one to be seen or heard there, nothing but horses tied and donkeys tied and the tents as they were."
- 11 *And he called the porters; and they told it to the king's house within.* Then the gatekeepers called out. It was told within the king's household.
- 12 *And the king arose in the night, and said unto his servants, I will now shew you what the Syrians have done to us. They know that we be hungry; therefore are they gone out of the camp to hide themselves in the field, saying, When they come out of the city, we shall catch them alive, and get into the city.* The king arose in the night and said to his servants, "I will tell you what the Syrians have done to us. They know that we are hungry. Therefore they have gone out of the camp to hide themselves in the open country, thinking, 'When they come out of the city, we shall take them alive and get into the city.' "

- 13 *And one of his servants answered and said, Let some take, I pray thee, five of the horses that remain, which are left in the city, (behold, they are as all the multitude of Israel that are left in it: behold, I say, they are even as all the multitude of the Israelites that are consumed:) and let us send and see.* One of his servants said, "Let some men take five of the remaining horses, seeing that those who are left here will fare like the whole crowd of Israel who have already perished. Let us send and see."
- 14 *They took therefore two chariot horses; and the king sent after the host of the Syrians, saying, Go and see.* So they took two horsemen, and the king sent them after the army of the Syrians, saying, "Go and see."
- 15 *And they went after them unto Jordan: and, lo, all the way was full of garments and vessels, which the Syrians had cast away in their haste. And the messengers returned, and told the king.* So they went after them as far as the Jordan. All the way was littered with garments and equipment that the Syrians had thrown away in their haste. And the messengers returned and told the king.
- 16 *And the people went out, and spoiled the tents of the Syrians. So a measure of fine flour was sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, according to the word of the LORD.* Then the people went out and plundered the camp of the Syrians. So a measure of fine flour was sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, according to the word of the LORD.
- 17 *And the king appointed the lord on whose hand he leaned to have the charge of the gate: and the people trode upon him in the gate, and he died, as the man of God had said, who spake when the king came down to him.* Now the king had appointed the captain on whose hand he leaned to have charge of the gate. And the people trampled him in the gate, so that he died, as the man of God had said when the king came down to him.

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And it came to pass as the man of God had spoken to the king, saying, Two measures of barley for a shekel, and a measure of fine flour for a shekel, shall be to morrow about this time in the gate of Samaria:
- For when the man of God had said to the king, "Two measures of barley shall be sold for a shekel, and a measure of fine flour for a shekel, about this time tomorrow in the gate of Samaria,"
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And that lord answered the man of God, and said, Now, behold, if the LORD should make windows in heaven, might such a thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.
- The captain had answered the man of God, "If the LORD Himself should make windows in heaven, could such a thing be?" And He had said, "You shall see it with Your own eyes, but You shall not eat of it."
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And so it fell out unto him: for the people trode upon him in the gate, and he died.
- So it happened to Him, for the people trampled him in the gate and he died.

Words in this chapter:

Hittites (*HIT*-ytes) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 3:5; Ex 16:12; Ezek 37:4; 1 Sam 11:9; Ex 9:5-6
- v2 — Gen 18:12-14; Mal 3:10; Gen 7:11; Rom 3:3; 2 Tim 2:13
- v3 — Lev 13:45-46; Num 5:2-4
- v4 — Jer 14:18
- v6 — 2 Sam 5:24; Isa 31:1; 1 Kgs 10:29
- v7 — Prov 28:1; Ps 48:4-6
- v9 — Isa 52:7
- v16 — 2 Kgs 7:1
- v19 — 2 Kgs 7:2

<i>Jehoram of Judah — 848–841 BC</i>
<i>Ahaziah of Judah — 841 BC</i>

Chapter 8

Elisha warned the Shunammite woman of a seven-year famine, and she returned to find her land restored by the king. Elisha wept as he told Hazael he would become king of Syria and harm Israel; Jehoram and then Ahaziah reigned in Judah.

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| <p>1 <i>Then spake Elisha unto the woman, whose son he had restored to life, saying, Arise, and go thou and thine household, and sojourn wheresoever thou canst sojourn: for the LORD hath called for a famine; and it shall also come upon the land seven years.</i></p> | <p>Now Elisha had said to the woman whose son he had restored to life, "Arise, and depart with your household, and stay wherever you can, for the LORD has called for a famine. It will come upon the land for seven years."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the woman arose, and did after the saying of the man of God: and she went with her household, and sojourned in the land of the Philistines seven years.</i></p> | <p>So the woman arose and did according to the word of the man of God. She went with her household and stayed in the land of the Philistines seven years.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And it came to pass at the seven years' end, that the woman returned out of the land of the Philistines: and she went forth to cry unto the king for her house and for her land.</i></p> | <p>At the end of the seven years, when the woman returned from the land of the Philistines, she went to appeal to the king for her house and her land.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the king talked with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, Tell me, I pray thee, all the great things that Elisha hath done.</i></p> | <p>Now the king was talking with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, "Tell me all the great things that Elisha has done."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And it came to pass, as he was telling the king how he had restored a dead body to life, that, behold, the woman, whose son he had restored to life, cried to the king for her house and for her land. And Gehazi said, My lord, O king, this is the woman, and this is her son, whom Elisha restored to life.</i></p> | <p>While he was telling the king how Elisha had restored the dead to life, the woman whose son he had restored to life appealed to the king for her house and her land. And Gehazi said, "My lord, O king, here is the woman, and here is her son whom Elisha restored to life."</p> |

- 6 *And when the king asked the woman, she told him. So the king appointed unto her a certain officer, saying, Restore all that was hers, and all the fruits of the field since the day that she left the land, even until now.* When the king asked the woman, she told him. So the king appointed an official for her, saying, "Restore all that was hers, together with all the produce of the fields from the day that she left the land until now."
- 7 *And Elisha came to Damascus; and Benhadad the king of Syria was sick; and it was told him, saying, The man of God is come hither.* Now Elisha came to Damascus. Ben-hadad the king of Syria was sick, and when it was told him, "The man of God has come here,"
- 8 *And the king said unto Hazael, Take a present in thine hand, and go, meet the man of God, and enquire of the LORD by him, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?* The king said to Hazael, "Take a present with you and go to meet the man of God, and inquire of the LORD through Him, saying, 'Shall I recover from this sickness?'"
- 9 *So Hazael went to meet him, and took a present with him, even of every good thing of Damascus, forty camels' burden, and came and stood before him, and said, Thy son Benhadad king of Syria hath sent me to thee, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?* So Hazael went to meet Him, and took a present with Him, all kinds of goods of Damascus, forty camel-loads. When He came and stood before Him, He said, "Your son Ben-hadad king of Syria has sent me to You, saying, 'Shall I recover from this sickness?'"
- 10 *And Elisha said unto him, Go, say unto him, Thou mayest certainly recover: howbeit the LORD hath shewed me that he shall surely die.* Elisha said to him, "Go, say to him, 'You shall certainly recover,' but the LORD has shown me that He shall certainly die."
- 11 *And he settled his countenance stedfastly, until he was ashamed: and the man of God wept.* He fixed his gaze and stared at him, until he was embarrassed. And the man of God wept.

- 12 *And Hazael said, Why weepeth my lord? And he answered, Because I know the evil that thou wilt do unto the children of Israel: their strong holds wilt thou set on fire, and their young men wilt thou slay with the sword, and wilt dash their children, and rip up their women with child.* Hazael said, "Why does my lord weep?" He answered, "Because I know the evil that you will do to the people of Israel. You will set on fire their fortresses, and you will kill their young men with the sword and dash in pieces their little ones and rip open their pregnant women."
- 13 *And Hazael said, But what, is thy servant a dog, that he should do this great thing? And Elisha answered, The LORD hath shewed me that thou shalt be king over Syria.* Hazael said, "What is Your servant, who is but a dog, that He should do this great thing?" Elisha answered, "The LORD has shown me that You are to be king over Syria."
- 14 *Then he departed from Elisha, and came to his master; who said to him, What said Elisha to thee? And he answered, He told me that thou shouldest surely recover.* Then he departed from Elisha and came to his master, who said to him, "What did Elisha say to you?" And he answered, "He told me that you would certainly recover."
- 15 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that he took a thick cloth, and dipped it in water, and spread it on his face, so that he died: and Hazael reigned in his stead.* But the next day he took the cloth and dipped it in water and spread it over his face, till he died. And Hazael became king in his place.
- 16 *And in the fifth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel, Jehoshaphat being then king of Judah, Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah began to reign.* In the fifth year of Joram the son of Ahab, king of Israel, Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat, king of Judah, began to reign.
- 17 *Thirty and two years old was he when he began to reign; and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.* He was thirty-two years old when he became king. He reigned eight years in Jerusalem.

- 18 *And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as did the house of Ahab: for the daughter of Ahab was his wife: and he did evil in the sight of the LORD.* He walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as the house of Ahab had done, for the daughter of Ahab was his wife. And he did what was evil in the sight of the LORD.
- 19 *Yet the LORD would not destroy Judah for David his servant's sake, as he promised him to give him alway a light, and to his children.* Yet the LORD was not willing to destroy Judah, for the sake of David his servant, since he promised to give a lamp to him and to His sons forever.
- 20 *In his days Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah, and made a king over themselves.* In His days Edom revolted from the rule of Judah and set up a king of their own.
- 21 *So Joram went over to Zair, and all the chariots with him: and he rose by night, and smote the Edomites which compassed him about, and the captains of the chariots: and the people fled into their tents.* Then Joram passed over to Zair with all his chariots and rose by night. He and his chariot commanders struck the Edomites who had surrounded Him. But His army fled home.
- 22 *Yet Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah unto this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time.* So Edom revolted from the rule of Judah to this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time.
- 23 *And the rest of the acts of Joram, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Joram and all that He did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 24 *And Joram slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David: and Ahaziah his son reigned in his stead.* So Joram slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place.
- 25 *In the twelfth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel did Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah begin to reign.* In the twelfth year of Joram the son of Ahab, king of Israel, Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, king of Judah, began to reign.

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| <p>26 <i>Two and twenty years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign; and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Athaliah, the daughter of Omri king of Israel.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And he walked in the way of the house of Ahab, and did evil in the sight of the LORD, as did the house of Ahab: for he was the son in law of the house of Ahab.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And he went with Joram the son of Ahab to the war against Hazael king of Syria in Ramothgilead; and the Syrians wounded Joram.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And king Joram went back to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the Syrians had given him at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. And Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to see Joram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.</i></p> | <p>Ahaziah was twenty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Athaliah; she was a granddaughter of Omri king of Israel.</p> <p>He also walked in the way of the house of Ahab and did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, as the house of Ahab had done, for he was son-in-law to the house of Ahab.</p> <p>He went with Joram the son of Ahab to make war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth-gilead, and the Syrians wounded Joram.</p> <p>King Joram returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds that the Syrians had given him at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. And Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, king of Judah, went down to see Joram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen-z*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Kgs 4:31-35; Ruth 1:1; Hag 1:11; Ps 105:16

v6 — Prov 16:7; Prov 21:1; 2 Sam 9:7; 1 Chr 28:1; 2 Kgs 9:32

v7 — 2 Kgs 6:24; 1 Kgs 11:24

v8 — 1 Kgs 19:15; 2 Kgs 1:2

v12 — Hos 13:16; Nah 3:10; 2 Kgs 15:16; 2 Kgs 12:17; 2 Kgs 13:3

v13 — 1 Sam 17:43; 1 Kgs 19:15

v16 — 2 Kgs 1:17

v19 — 1 Kgs 11:36

v20 — 1 Kgs 22:47

Chapter 9

Elisha sent a young prophet to anoint Jehu king over Israel with a commission to destroy the house of Ahab. Jehu killed King Jehoram of Israel and King Ahaziah of Judah; Jezebel was thrown from a window and eaten by dogs as Elijah had prophesied.

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| <p>1 <i>And Elisha the prophet called one of the children of the prophets, and said unto him, Gird up thy loins, and take this box of oil in thine hand, and go to Ramothgilead:</i></p> | <p>Now Elisha the prophet called one of the sons of the prophets and said to him, "Tie up your garment, and take this flask of oil in your hand, and go to Ramoth-gilead.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And when thou comest thither, look out there Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi, and go in, and make him arise up from among his brethren, and carry him to an inner chamber;</i></p> | <p>When you arrive, look there for Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat, son of Nimshi. And go in and have him rise from among his fellows, and lead him to an inner chamber.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then take the box of oil, and pour it on his head, and say, Thus saith the LORD, I have anointed thee king over Israel. Then open the door, and flee, and tarry not.</i></p> | <p>Then take the flask of oil and pour it on His head and say, 'Thus says the LORD, I anoint You king over Israel.' Then open the door and flee; do not linger."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>So the young man, even the young man the prophet, went to Ramothgilead.</i></p> | <p>So the young man, the servant of the prophet, went to Ramoth-gilead.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And when he came, behold, the captains of the host were sitting; and he said, I have an errand to thee, O captain. And Jehu said, Unto which of all us? And he said, To thee, O captain.</i></p> | <p>When he came, the commanders of the army were in council. And he said, "I have a word for you, O commander." And Jehu said, "To which of us all?" And he said, "To you, O commander."</p> |

- 6 *And he arose, and went into the house; and he poured the oil on his head, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I have anointed thee king over the people of the LORD, even over Israel.* So He arose and went into the house. And the young man poured the oil on His head, saying to Him, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, I anoint You king over the people of the LORD, over Israel.
- 7 *And thou shalt smite the house of Ahab thy master, that I may avenge the blood of my servants the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the LORD, at the hand of Jezebel.* You shall strike down the house of Ahab your master, so that I may avenge the blood of my servants the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the LORD, at the hand of Jezebel.
- 8 *For the whole house of Ahab shall perish: and I will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel:* For the whole house of Ahab shall perish. I will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, both bond and free in Israel.
- 9 *And I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah:* I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah.
- 10 *And the dogs shall eat Jezebel in the portion of Jezreel, and there shall be none to bury her. And he opened the door, and fled.* The dogs shall eat Jezebel in the plot of ground at Jezreel, and none shall bury her." Then he opened the door and fled.
- 11 *Then Jehu came forth to the servants of his lord: and one said unto him, Is all well? wherefore came this mad fellow to thee? And he said unto them, Ye know the man, and his communication.* When Jehu came out to the servants of his master, they said to him, "Is all well? Why did this mad fellow come to you?" And he said to them, "You know the fellow and his talk."
- 12 *And they said, It is false; tell us now. And he said, Thus and thus spake he to me, saying, Thus saith the LORD, I have anointed thee king over Israel.* They said, "That is not true; tell us now." And He said, "Thus and so He spoke to me, saying, 'Thus says the LORD, I anoint You king over Israel.'"

- 13 *Then they hasted, and took every man his garment, and put it under him on the top of the stairs, and blew with trumpets, saying, Jehu is king.* Then in haste every man of them took his garment and put it under him on the bare steps. They blew the trumpet and proclaimed, "Jehu is king."
- 14 *So Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi conspired against Joram. (Now Joram had kept Ramothgilead, he and all Israel, because of Hazael king of Syria.* Thus Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi conspired against Joram. Now Joram with all Israel had been on guard at Ramoth-gilead against Hazael king of Syria,
- 15 *But king Joram was returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the Syrians had given him, when he fought with Hazael king of Syria.) And Jehu said, If it be your minds, then let none go forth nor escape out of the city to go to tell it in Jezreel.* But King Joram had returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds that the Syrians had given him, when he fought with Hazael king of Syria. So Jehu said, "If this is your decision, then let no one slip out of the city to go and tell the news in Jezreel."
- 16 *So Jehu rode in a chariot, and went to Jezreel; for Joram lay there. And Ahaziah king of Judah was come down to see Joram.* Then Jehu mounted his chariot and went to Jezreel, for Joram lay there. And Ahaziah king of Judah had come down to visit Joram.
- 17 *And there stood a watchman on the tower in Jezreel, and he spied the company of Jehu as he came, and said, I see a company. And Joram said, Take an horseman, and send to meet them, and let him say, Is it peace?* Now the watchman was standing on the tower in Jezreel. He saw the company of Jehu as he came and said, "I see a company." And Joram said, "Take a horseman and send to meet them, and let him say, 'Is it peace?'"
- 18 *So there went one on horseback to meet him, and said, Thus saith the king, Is it peace? And Jehu said, What hast thou to do with peace? turn thee behind me. And the watchman told, saying, The messenger came to them, but he cometh not again.* So a man on horseback went to meet him and said, "Thus says the king, 'Is it peace?'" And Jehu said, "What do you have to do with peace? Turn around and ride behind me." And the watchman reported, "The messenger reached them. But he is not coming back."

- 19 *Then he sent out a second on horseback, which came to them, and said, Thus saith the king, Is it peace? And Jehu answered, What hast thou to do with peace? turn thee behind me.* Then he sent out a second horseman, who came to them and said, "Thus the king says, 'Is it peace?'" And Jehu answered, "What do you have to do with peace? Turn around and ride behind me."
- 20 *And the watchman told, saying, He came even unto them, and cometh not again: and the driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi; for he driveth furiously.* Again the watchman reported, "He reached them. But he is not coming back. And the driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi, for he drives furiously."
- 21 *And Joram said, Make ready. And his chariot was made ready. And Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah went out, each in his chariot, and they went out against Jehu, and met him in the portion of Naboth the Jezreelite.* Joram said, "Make ready." And they made ready his chariot. Then Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah set out, each in his chariot, and went to meet Jehu, and met him in the property of Naboth the Jezreelite.
- 22 *And it came to pass, when Joram saw Jehu, that he said, Is it peace, Jehu? And he answered, What peace, so long as the whoredoms of thy mother Jezebel and her witchcrafts are so many?* When Joram saw Jehu, he said, "Is it peace, Jehu?" He answered, "What peace can there be, so long as the whorings and the sorceries of your mother Jezebel are so many?"
- 23 *And Joram turned his hands, and fled, and said to Ahaziah, There is treachery, O Ahaziah.* Then Joram reined about and fled, saying to Ahaziah, "Treachery, O Ahaziah!"
- 24 *And Jehu drew a bow with his full strength, and smote Jehoram between his arms, and the arrow went out at his heart, and he sunk down in his chariot.* Jehu drew his bow with his full strength, and shot Joram between the shoulders, so that the arrow pierced his heart. He sank in his chariot.

- 25 *Then said Jehu to Bidkar his captain, Take up, and cast him in the portion of the field of Naboth the Jezreelite: for remember how that, when I and thou rode together after Ahab his father, the LORD laid this burden upon him;* Jehu said to Bidkar his aide, "Take him up and throw Him on the plot of ground belonging to Naboth the Jezreelite. For remember, when You and I rode side by side behind Ahab his father, how the LORD uttered this oracle against Him:
- 26 *Surely I have seen yesterday the blood of Naboth, and the blood of his sons, saith the LORD; and I will requite thee in this plat, saith the LORD. Now therefore take and cast him into the plat of ground, according to the word of the LORD.* 'As surely as I saw yesterday the blood of Naboth and the blood of His sons, declares the LORD, I will repay You on this plot of ground, declares the LORD.' Now therefore take Him up and throw Him on the plot of ground, according to the word of the LORD."
- 27 *But when Ahaziah the king of Judah saw this, he fled by the way of the garden house. And Jehu followed after him, and said, Smite him also in the chariot. And they did so at the going up to Gur, which is by Ibleam. And he fled to Megiddo, and died there.* When Ahaziah the king of Judah saw this, he fled by the way of the garden house. And Jehu pursued him and said, "Shoot him also." And they shot him in the chariot at the ascent of Gur, which is by Ibleam. And he fled to Megiddo and died there.
- 28 *And his servants carried him in a chariot to Jerusalem, and buried him in his sepulchre with his fathers in the city of David.* His servants carried him in a chariot to Jerusalem, and buried him in his tomb with his fathers in the city of David.
- 29 *And in the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab began Ahaziah to reign over Judah.* In the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab, Ahaziah began to reign over Judah.
- 30 *And when Jehu was come to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it; and she painted her face, and tired her head, and looked out at a window.* When Jehu came to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it. And she painted her eyes and adorned her head and looked out the window.

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| 31 | <i>And as Jehu entered in at the gate, she said, Had Zimri peace, who slew his master?</i> | As Jehu entered the gate, she said, "Is it peace, you Zimri, murderer of your master?" |
| 32 | <i>And he lifted up his face to the window, and said, Who is on my side? who? And there looked out to him two or three eunuchs.</i> | He lifted up his face to the window and said, "Who is on my side? Who?" Two or three eunuchs looked out at him. |
| 33 | <i>And he said, Throw her down. So they threw her down: and some of her blood was sprinkled on the wall, and on the horses: and he trode her under foot.</i> | He said, "Throw her down." So they threw her down. And some of her blood spattered on the wall and on the horses. He trampled over her. |
| 34 | <i>And when he was come in, he did eat and drink, and said, Go, see now this cursed woman, and bury her: for she is a king's daughter.</i> | Then he went in and ate and drank. And he said, "See now to this cursed woman and bury her, for she is a king's daughter." |
| 35 | <i>And they went to bury her: but they found no more of her than the skull, and the feet, and the palms of her hands.</i> | But when they went to bury her, they found no more of her than the skull and the feet and the palms of her hands. |
| 36 | <i>Wherefore they came again, and told him. And he said, This is the word of the LORD, which he spake by his servant Elijah the Tishbite, saying, In the portion of Jezreel shall dogs eat the flesh of Jezebel:</i> | When they came back and told Him, He said, "This is the word of the LORD, which He spoke by His servant Elijah the Tishbite: 'In the plot of ground at Jezreel the dogs shall eat the flesh of Jezebel, |
| 37 | <i>And the carcase of Jezebel shall be as dung upon the face of the field in the portion of Jezreel; so that they shall not say, This is Jezebel.</i> | The corpse of Jezebel shall be as dung on the surface of the field in the plot at Jezreel, so that no one can say, This is Jezebel.' " |

Words in this chapter:

Jezebel (JEZ-eh-bel) — Ahab's Phoenician queen — aggressively promoted Baal worship and persecuted the prophets of God; killed Naboth to take his vineyard; eaten by dogs as prophesied.

Megiddo (*meh-GID-oh*) — A strategic city at the pass through the Carmel range — site of many decisive battles; in Revelation, Armageddon (Har-Megiddo) is the great final battlefield.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Sam 10:1; 2 Kgs 4:29
- v2 — 2 Kgs 9:14; 2 Kgs 9:5; 2 Kgs 9:11
- v3 — 1 Kgs 19:16
- v7 — 1 Kgs 18:4; 1 Kgs 21:15; Deut 32:43
- v8 — 1 Sam 25:22; Deut 32:36
- v9 — 1 Kgs 15:29
- v10 — 2 Kgs 9:35-36; 1 Kgs 21:23
- v13 — 1 Kgs 1:34; Mark 11:7-8; 1 Kgs 1:39
- v22 — Nah 3:4; 2 Chr 21:13
- v27 — Judg 1:27
- v30 — Jer 4:30; Ezek 23:40
- v36 — 1 Kgs 21:23

Jehu of Israel — 841–814 BC

Chapter 10

Jehu slaughtered all seventy of Ahab's sons and all his supporters, then destroyed the worshipers of Baal by luring them into the temple and massacring them. However, Jehu did not depart from the golden calves at Bethel and Dan; Hazael of Syria began to conquer Israel's territory.

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| <p>1 <i>And Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. And Jehu wrote letters, and sent to Samaria, unto the rulers of Jezreel, to the elders, and to them that brought up Ahab's children, saying,</i></p> | <p>Now Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. So Jehu wrote letters and sent them to Samaria, to the rulers of the city, to the elders, and to the guardians of the sons of Ahab, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Now as soon as this letter cometh to you, seeing your master's sons are with you, and there are with you chariots and horses, a fenced city also, and armour;</i></p> | <p>"Now then, as soon as this letter comes to you, seeing your master's sons are with you, and there are with you chariots and horses, fortified cities also, and weapons,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Look even out the best and meetest of your master's sons, and set him on his father's throne, and fight for your master's house.</i></p> | <p>Select the best and fittest of your master's sons and set him on his father's throne and fight for your master's house."</p> |

- 4 *But they were exceedingly afraid, and said, Behold, two kings stood not before him: how then shall we stand?* But they were greatly afraid and said, "the two kings could not stand before him. How then can we stand?"
- 5 *And he that was over the house, and he that was over the city, the elders also, and the bringers up of the children, sent to Jehu, saying, We are thy servants, and will do all that thou shalt bid us; we will not make any king: do thou that which is good in thine eyes.* So he who was over the palace household. He who was over the city, together with the elders and the guardians, sent to Jehu, saying, "We are your servants. We will do all that you tell us. We will not make anyone king. Do whatever is good in your eyes."
- 6 *Then he wrote a letter the second time to them, saying, If ye be mine, and if ye will hearken unto my voice, take ye the heads of the men your master's sons, and come to me to Jezreel by to morrow this time. Now the king's sons, being seventy persons, were with the great men of the city, which brought them up.* Then he wrote them a second letter, saying, "If you are on my side, and if you are ready to obey me, take the heads of your master's sons and come to me at Jezreel tomorrow at this time." Now the king's sons, seventy persons, were with the great men of the city, who were bringing them up.
- 7 *And it came to pass, when the letter came to them, that they took the king's sons, and slew seventy persons, and put their heads in baskets, and sent him them to Jezreel.* When the letter came to them, they took the king's sons and slaughtered them, seventy persons, and put their heads in baskets and sent them to him at Jezreel.
- 8 *And there came a messenger, and told him, saying, They have brought the heads of the king's sons. And he said, Lay ye them in two heaps at the entering in of the gate until the morning.* When the messenger came and told him, "They have brought the heads of the king's sons," he said, "Lay them in two heaps at the entrance of the gate until the morning."

- 9 *And it came to pass in the morning, that he went out, and stood, and said to all the people, Ye be righteous: behold, I conspired against my master, and slew him: but who slew all these?* Then in the morning, when he went out, he stood and said to all the people, "You are innocent. It was I who conspired against my master and killed him, but who struck down all these?"
- 10 *Know now that there shall fall unto the earth nothing of the word of the LORD, which the LORD spake concerning the house of Ahab: for the LORD hath done that which he spake by his servant Elijah.* Know then that there shall fall to the earth nothing of the word of the LORD, which the LORD spoke concerning the house of Ahab, for the LORD has done what He said by His servant Elijah."
- 11 *So Jehu slew all that remained of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, and all his great men, and his kinsfolks, and his priests, until he left him none remaining.* So Jehu struck down all who remained of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, all his great men and his close friends and his priests, until he left him none remaining.
- 12 *And he arose and departed, and came to Samaria. And as he was at the shearing house in the way,* Then he set out and went to Samaria. On the way, when he was at the shearing house,
- 13 *Jehu met with the brethren of Ahaziah king of Judah, and said, Who are ye? And they answered, We are the brethren of Ahaziah; and we go down to salute the children of the king and the children of the queen.* Jehu met the relatives of Ahaziah king of Judah. He said, "Who are you?" And they answered, "We are the relatives of Ahaziah. We came down to visit the royal princes and the sons of the queen mother."
- 14 *And he said, Take them alive. And they took them alive, and slew them at the pit of the shearing house, even two and forty men; neither left he any of them.* He said, "Take them alive." And they took them alive and slaughtered them at the pit of the shearing house, forty-two persons. He spared none of them.

- 15 *And when he was departed thence, he lighted on Jehonadab the son of Rechab coming to meet him: and he saluted him, and said to him, Is thine heart right, as my heart is with thy heart? And Jehonadab answered, It is. If it be, give me thine hand. And he gave him his hand; and he took him up to him into the chariot.* When he departed from there, he met Jehonadab the son of Rechab coming to meet him. And he greeted him and said to him, "Is your heart true to my heart as mine is to yours?" And Jehonadab answered, "It is." Jehu said, "If it is, give me your hand." So he gave him his hand. And Jehu took him up with him into the chariot.
- 16 *And he said, Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD. So they made him ride in his chariot.* He said, "Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD." So He had Him ride in his chariot.
- 17 *And when he came to Samaria, he slew all that remained unto Ahab in Samaria, till he had destroyed him, according to the saying of the LORD, which he spake to Elijah.* When He came to Samaria, He struck down all who remained to Ahab in Samaria, till he had wiped them out, according to the word of the LORD that He spoke to Elijah.
- 18 *And Jehu gathered all the people together, and said unto them, Ahab served Baal a little; but Jehu shall serve him much.* Then Jehu assembled all the people and said to them, "Ahab served Baal a little, but Jehu will serve him much.
- 19 *Now therefore call unto me all the prophets of Baal, all his servants, and all his priests; let none be wanting: for I have a great sacrifice to do to Baal; whosoever shall be wanting, he shall not live. But Jehu did it in subtilty, to the intent that he might destroy the worshippers of Baal.* Now therefore call to me all the prophets of Baal, all his worshipers and all his priests. Let none be missing, for I have a great sacrifice to offer to Baal. Whoever is missing shall not live." But Jehu did it with cunning in order to destroy the worshipers of Baal.
- 20 *And Jehu said, Proclaim a solemn assembly for Baal. And they proclaimed it.* Jehu said, "Sanctify a solemn assembly for Baal." So they proclaimed it.

- 21 *And Jehu sent through all Israel: and all the worshippers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left that came not. And they came into the house of Baal; and the house of Baal was full from one end to another.* Jehu sent throughout all Israel. All the worshipers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left who did not come. And they entered the house of Baal, and the house of Baal was filled from one end to the other.
- 22 *And he said unto him that was over the vestry, Bring forth vestments for all the worshippers of Baal. And he brought them forth vestments.* He said to him who was in charge of the wardrobe, "Bring out the vestments for all the worshipers of Baal." So he brought out the vestments for them.
- 23 *And Jehu went, and Jehonadab the son of Rechab, into the house of Baal, and said unto the worshippers of Baal, Search, and look that there be here with you none of the servants of the LORD, but the worshippers of Baal only.* Then Jehu went into the house of Baal with Jehonadab the son of Rechab. He said to the worshipers of Baal, "Search, and see that there is no servant of the LORD here among You, but only the worshipers of Baal."
- 24 *And when they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings, Jehu appointed fourscore men without, and said, If any of the men whom I have brought into your hands escape, he that letteth him go, his life shall be for the life of him.* Then they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings. Now Jehu had stationed eighty men outside and said, "The man who allows any of those whom I give into your hands to escape shall forfeit his life."
- 25 *And it came to pass, as soon as he had made an end of offering the burnt offering, that Jehu said to the guard and to the captains, Go in, and slay them; let none come forth. And they smote them with the edge of the sword; and the guard and the captains cast them out, and went to the city of the house of Baal.* As soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, Jehu commanded the guard and the officers, "Go in and strike them down; let not a man escape." So when they put them to the sword, the guard and the officers cast them out and went into the inner room of the house of Baal,

- 26 *And they brought forth the images out of the house of Baal, and burned them.* They brought out the pillar that was in the house of Baal and burned it.
- 27 *And they brake down the image of Baal, and brake down the house of Baal, and made it a draught house unto this day.* They demolished the pillar of Baal, and demolished the house of Baal, and made it a latrine to this day.
- 28 *Thus Jehu destroyed Baal out of Israel.* Thus Jehu wiped out Baal from Israel.
- 29 *Howbeit from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, Jehu departed not from after them, to wit, the golden calves that were in Bethel, and that were in Dan.* But Jehu did not turn aside from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin—that is, the golden calves that were in Bethel and in Dan.
- 30 *And the LORD said unto Jehu, Because thou hast done well in executing that which is right in mine eyes, and hast done unto the house of Ahab according to all that was in mine heart, thy children of the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel.* The LORD said to Jehu, "Because you have done well in carrying out what is right in my eyes, and have done to the house of Ahab according to all that was in my heart, your sons of the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel."
- 31 *But Jehu took no heed to walk in the law of the LORD God of Israel with all his heart: for he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, which made Israel to sin.* But Jehu was not careful to walk in the law of the LORD, the God of Israel, with all His heart. He did not turn from the sins of Jeroboam, which he made Israel to sin.
- 32 *In those days the LORD began to cut Israel short: and Hazael smote them in all the coasts of Israel;* In those days the LORD began to cut off parts of Israel. Hazael defeated them throughout the territory of Israel:
- 33 *From Jordan eastward, all the land of Gilead, the Gadites, and the Reubenites, and the Manassites, from Aroer, which is by the river Arnon, even Gilead and Bashan.* From the Jordan eastward, all the land of Gilead, the Gadites, and the Reubenites, and the Manassites, from Aroer, which is by the Valley of the Arnon, that is, Gilead and Bashan.

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| 34 | <i>Now the rest of the acts of Jehu, and all that he did, and all his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?</i> | Now the rest of the acts of Jehu and all that he did. All his might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? |
| 35 | <i>And Jehu slept with his fathers: and they buried him in Samaria. And Jehoahaz his son reigned in his stead.</i> | So Jehu slept with his fathers. They buried him in Samaria. And Jehoahaz his son reigned in his place. |
| 36 | <i>And the time that Jehu reigned over Israel in Samaria was twenty and eight years.</i> | The time that Jehu reigned over Israel in Samaria was twenty-eight years. |

Words in this chapter:

- letteth** — Hinders or restrains — in 2 Thessalonians 2:7, 'he who now letteth' means 'the one who now restrains'; opposite of the modern meaning of 'let.'
- wit** — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'
- Dan** (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'
- Bashan** (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Cross-References:

- v10** — 1 Kgs 21:29; 1 Kgs 21:19; 2 Kgs 9:7-10
- v13** — 2 Kgs 8:29
- v15** — Jer 35:14-19
- v16** — 1 Kgs 19:10
- v17** — 2 Kgs 9:8
- v18** — 1 Kgs 16:31-32
- v19** — 1 Kgs 22:6
- v20** — Joel 1:14
- v26** — 1 Kgs 14:23
- v29** — 1 Kgs 12:28-30
- v31** — Prov 4:23; 2 Kgs 10:29
- v32** — 1 Kgs 19:17; 2 Kgs 8:12

Athaliah of Judah — 841–835 BC

Chapter 11

When Athaliah saw her son Ahaziah was dead, she killed all the royal family and seized the throne of Judah, but the infant Joash was hidden by his aunt. After six years, Jehoiada the priest crowned Joash king, and Athaliah was executed.

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| 1 | <i>And when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the seed royal.</i> | Now when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the royal family. |
| 2 | <i>But Jehosheba, the daughter of king Joram, sister of Ahaziah, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him from among the king's sons which were slain; and they hid him, even him and his nurse, in the bedchamber from Athaliah, so that he was not slain.</i> | But Jehosheba, the daughter of King Joram, sister of Ahaziah, took Joash the son of Ahaziah and stole him away from among the king's sons who were being put to death. She put him and his nurse in a bedroom. Thus they hid him from Athaliah, so that he was not put to death. |
| 3 | <i>And he was with her hid in the house of the LORD six years. And Athaliah did reign over the land.</i> | He remained with her six years, hidden in the house of the LORD, while Athaliah reigned over the land. |
| 4 | <i>And the seventh year Jehoiada sent and fetched the rulers over hundreds, with the captains and the guard, and brought them to him into the house of the LORD, and made a covenant with them, and took an oath of them in the house of the LORD, and shewed them the king's son.</i> | But in the seventh year Jehoiada sent and brought the captains of the Carites and of the guard, and had them come to Him in the house of the LORD. And He made a covenant with them and put them under oath in the house of the LORD. He showed them the king's son. |
| 5 | <i>And he commanded them, saying, This is the thing that ye shall do; A third part of you that enter in on the sabbath shall even be keepers of the watch of the king's house;</i> | He commanded them, "This is the thing that you shall do: one third of you, those who come off duty on the Sabbath and guard the king's house |

- 6 *And a third part shall be at the gate of Sur; and a third part at the gate behind the guard: so shall ye keep the watch of the house, that it be not broken down.* (another third being at the gate Sur and a third at the gate behind the guards) shall guard the palace.
- 7 *And two parts of all you that go forth on the sabbath, even they shall keep the watch of the house of the LORD about the king.* The two divisions of You, which come on duty in force on the Sabbath and guard the house of the LORD on behalf of the king,
- 8 *And ye shall compass the king round about, every man with his weapons in his hand: and he that cometh within the ranges, let him be slain: and be ye with the king as he goeth out and as he cometh in.* Shall surround the king, each with his weapons in his hand. And whoever approaches the ranks is to be put to death. Be with the king when he goes out and when he comes in."
- 9 *And the captains over the hundreds did according to all things that Jehoiada the priest commanded: and they took every man his men that were to come in on the sabbath, with them that should go out on the sabbath, and came to Jehoiada the priest.* The captains did according to all that Jehoiada the priest commanded. And each captain took his men who were to come on duty on the Sabbath, with those who were to go off duty on the Sabbath, and came to Jehoiada the priest.
- 10 *And to the captains over hundreds did the priest give king David's spears and shields, that were in the temple of the LORD.* The priest gave to the captains the spears and shields that had been King David's, which were in the house of the LORD.
- 11 *And the guard stood, every man with his weapons in his hand, round about the king, from the right corner of the temple to the left corner of the temple, along by the altar and the temple.* The guards stood, every man with his weapons in his hand, from the south side of the house to the north side of the house, around the altar and the house on behalf of the king.

- 12 *And he brought forth the king's son, and put the crown upon him, and gave him the testimony; and they made him king, and anointed him; and they clapped their hands, and said, God save the king.* Then he brought out the king's son and put the crown on him and gave him the testimony. And they proclaimed him king and anointed him. They clapped their hands and said, "Long live the king!"
- 13 *And when Athaliah heard the noise of the guard and of the people, she came to the people into the temple of the LORD.* When Athaliah heard the noise of the guard and of the people, she went into the house of the LORD to the people.
- 14 *And when she looked, behold, the king stood by a pillar, as the manner was, and the princes and the trumpeters were by the king, and all the people of the land rejoiced, and blew with trumpets: and Athaliah rent her clothes, and cried, Treason, Treason.* When she looked, there was the king standing by the pillar, according to the custom, with the captains and the trumpeters beside the king. All the people of the land rejoicing and blowing trumpets. And Athaliah tore her clothes and cried, "Treason! Treason!"
- 15 *But Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains of the hundreds, the officers of the host, and said unto them, Have her forth without the ranges: and him that followeth her kill with the sword. For the priest had said, Let her not be slain in the house of the LORD.* Then Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains who were set over the army, "Bring her out between the ranks, and put to the sword anyone who follows her." For the priest said, "Let her not be put to death in the house of the LORD."
- 16 *And they laid hands on her; and she went by the way by the which the horses came into the king's house: and there was she slain.* So they laid hands on her. She went through the horses' entrance to the king's house, and there she was put to death.
- 17 *And Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people, that they should be the LORD'S people; between the king also and the people.* Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and people, that they should be the LORD's people, and also between the king and the people.

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| <p>18 <i>And all the people of the land went into the house of Baal, and brake it down; his altars and his images brake they in pieces thoroughly, and slew Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars. And the priest appointed officers over the house of the LORD.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And he took the rulers over hundreds, and the captains, and the guard, and all the people of the land; and they brought down the king from the house of the LORD, and came by the way of the gate of the guard to the king's house. And he sat on the throne of the kings.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was in quiet: and they slew Athaliah with the sword beside the king's house.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Seven years old was Jehoash when he began to reign.</i></p> | <p>Then all the people of the land went to the house of Baal and tore it down; His altars and His images they broke in pieces. They killed Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars. And the priest appointed overseers over the house of the LORD.</p> <p>He took the captains, the Carites, the guards. All the people of the land. They brought the king down from the house of the LORD, marching through the gate of the guards to the king's house. And he took his seat on the throne of the kings.</p> <p>So all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet after Athaliah had been put to death with the sword at the king's house.</p> <p>Jehoash was seven years old when he began to reign.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 41:1; 2 Kgs 25:25; 2 Chr 22:10-12
v5 — 1 Chr 9:25
v10 — 2 Sam 8:7
v12 — 1 Sam 10:24; Ex 25:16
v14 — 2 Chr 34:31; 2 Kgs 23:3
v17 — 2 Sam 5:3; 2 Chr 15:12-14
v18 — Deut 12:3
v21 — 2 Chr 24:1-14

Joash of Judah — 835–796 BC

Chapter 12

Joash reigned well in Judah as long as Jehoiada the priest lived, and he ordered the repair of the temple using a collection chest. When Hazael of Syria threatened Jerusalem, Joash paid him off with the temple treasury; Joash was later assassinated by his servants.

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| 1 <i>In the seventh year of Jehu Jehoash began to reign; and forty years reigned he in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Zibiah of Beersheba.</i> | In the seventh year of Jehu, Jehoash began to reign. He reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zibiah of Beersheba. |
| 2 <i>And Jehoash did that which was right in the sight of the LORD all his days wherein Jehoiada the priest instructed him.</i> | Jehoash did what was right in the eyes of the LORD all His days, because Jehoiada the priest instructed him. |
| 3 <i>But the high places were not taken away: the people still sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places.</i> | Nevertheless, the high places were not taken away; the people still sacrificed and made offerings on the high places. |
| 4 <i>And Jehoash said to the priests, All the money of the dedicated things that is brought into the house of the LORD, even the money of every one that passeth the account, the money that every man is set at, and all the money that cometh into any man's heart to bring into the house of the LORD,</i> | Jehoash said to the priests, "All the money of the holy things that is brought into the house of the LORD, the money for which each man is assessed—the money from the assessment of persons—and the money that a man's heart prompts him to bring into the house of the LORD, |
| 5 <i>Let the priests take it to them, every man of his acquaintance: and let them repair the breaches of the house, wheresoever any breach shall be found.</i> | Let the priests take, each from His donor, and let them repair the house wherever any need of repairs is discovered." |
| 6 <i>But it was so, that in the three and twentieth year of king Jehoash the priests had not repaired the breaches of the house.</i> | But by the twenty-third year of King Jehoash, the priests had made no repairs on the house. |

- 7 *Then king Jehoash called for Jehoiada the priest, and the other priests, and said unto them, Why repair ye not the breaches of the house? now therefore receive no more money of your acquaintance, but deliver it for the breaches of the house.* Then King Jehoash summoned Jehoiada the priest and the other priests and said to them, "Why are you not repairing the house? Now therefore take no more money from your donors, but hand it over for the repair of the house."
- 8 *And the priests consented to receive no more money of the people, neither to repair the breaches of the house.* So the priests agreed that they would take no more money from the people, and that they would not repair the house.
- 9 *But Jehoiada the priest took a chest, and bored a hole in the lid of it, and set it beside the altar, on the right side as one cometh into the house of the LORD: and the priests that kept the door put therein all the money that was brought into the house of the LORD.* Then Jehoiada the priest took a chest and bored a hole in the lid of it and set it beside the altar on the right side as one entered the house of the LORD. And the priests who guarded the threshold put in it all the money that was brought into the house of the LORD.
- 10 *And it was so, when they saw that there was much money in the chest, that the king's scribe and the high priest came up, and they put up in bags, and told the money that was found in the house of the LORD.* Whenever they saw that there was much money in the chest, the king's secretary and the high priest came up and they bagged and counted the money that was found in the house of the LORD.
- 11 *And they gave the money, being told, into the hands of them that did the work, that had the oversight of the house of the LORD: and they laid it out to the carpenters and builders, that wrought upon the house of the LORD,* Then they would give the money that was weighed out into the hands of the workmen who had the oversight of the house of the LORD. And they paid it out to the carpenters and the builders who worked on the house of the LORD,

- 12 *And to masons, and hewers of stone, and to buy timber and hewed stone to repair the breaches of the house of the LORD, and for all that was laid out for the house to repair it.* To the masons and the stonecutters, as well as to buy timber and quarried stone for making repairs on the house of the LORD, and for any outlay for the repairs of the house.
- 13 *Howbeit there were not made for the house of the LORD bowls of silver, snuffers, basons, trumpets, any vessels of gold, or vessels of silver, of the money that was brought into the house of the LORD:* But there were not made for the house of the LORD basins of silver, snuffers, bowls, trumpets, or any vessels of gold, or of silver, from the money that was brought into the house of the LORD,
- 14 *But they gave that to the workmen, and repaired therewith the house of the LORD.* For that was given to the workmen who were repairing the house of the LORD with it.
- 15 *Moreover they reckoned not with the men, into whose hand they delivered the money to be bestowed on workmen: for they dealt faithfully.* They did not ask for an accounting from the men into whose hand they delivered the money to pay out to the workmen, for they dealt honestly.
- 16 *The trespass money and sin money was not brought into the house of the LORD: it was the priests'.* The money from the guilt offerings and the money from the sin offerings was not brought into the house of the LORD; it belonged to the priests.
- 17 *Then Hazael king of Syria went up, and fought against Gath, and took it: and Hazael set his face to go up to Jerusalem.* At that time Hazael king of Syria went up and fought against Gath and took it. But when Hazael set His face to go up against Jerusalem,

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| <p>18 <i>And Jehoash king of Judah took all the hallowed things that Jehoshaphat, and Jehoram, and Ahaziah, his fathers, kings of Judah, had dedicated, and his own hallowed things, and all the gold that was found in the treasures of the house of the LORD, and in the king's house, and sent it to Hazael king of Syria: and he went away from Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i></p> <p>20 <i>And his servants arose, and made a conspiracy, and slew Joash in the house of Millo, which goeth down to Silla.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For Jozachar the son of Shimeath, and Jehozabad the son of Shomer, his servants, smote him, and he died; and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David: and Amaziah his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>Jehoash king of Judah took all the sacred gifts that Jehoshaphat and Jehoram and Ahaziah his fathers, the kings of Judah, had dedicated. His own sacred gifts. All the gold that was found in the treasures of the house of the LORD and of the king's house, and sent these to Hazael king of Syria. Then Hazael went away from Jerusalem.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Joash and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> <p>His servants arose and made a conspiracy and struck down Joash in the house of Millo, on the way that goes down to Silla.</p> <p>It was Jozacar the son of Shimeath and Jehozabad the son of Shomer, his servants, who struck him down, so that he died. And they buried him with his fathers in the city of David, and Amaziah his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

v3 — 2 Kgs 14:4

v4 — 2 Kgs 22:4; Ex 35:5; Ex 30:12-16

v9 — Mark 12:41

v13 — 2 Chr 24:14

v15 — 2 Kgs 22:7

v16 — Lev 7:7
v18 — 1 Kgs 15:18

Jehoahaz of Israel — 814–798 BC
Jehoash of Israel — 798–782 BC

Chapter 13

Jehoahaz and then Jehoash reigned over Israel, continuing in Jeroboam's sins, though the LORD showed Israel mercy. Elisha fell ill and died; even after death, a corpse thrown into his grave revived upon touching his bones.

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| 1 | <i>In the three and twentieth year of Joash the son of Ahaziah king of Judah Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned seventeen years.</i> | In the twenty-third year of Joash the son of Ahaziah, king of Judah, Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria. He reigned seventeen years. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, and followed the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which made Israel to sin; he departed not therefrom.</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD and followed the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin; He did not depart from them. |
| 3 | <i>And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel, and he delivered them into the hand of Hazael king of Syria, and into the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael, all their days.</i> | The anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel. He gave them continually into the hand of Hazael king of Syria and into the hand of Ben-hadad the son of Hazael. |
| 4 | <i>And Jehoahaz besought the LORD, and the LORD hearkened unto him: for he saw the oppression of Israel, because the king of Syria oppressed them.</i> | Then Jehoahaz sought the favor of the LORD. The LORD listened to Him, for He saw the oppression of Israel, how the king of Syria oppressed them. |
| 5 | <i>(And the LORD gave Israel a saviour, so that they went out from under the hand of the Syrians: and the children of Israel dwelt in their tents, as beforetime.</i> | (Therefore the LORD gave Israel a deliverer, so that they escaped from under the hand of the Syrians, and the people of Israel lived in their homes as formerly. |

- 6 *Nevertheless they departed not from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, who made Israel sin, but walked therein: and there remained the grove also in Samaria.)* Nevertheless, they did not depart from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, which he made Israel to sin, but walked in them. The grove also remained in Samaria.)
- 7 *Neither did he leave of the people to Jehoahaz but fifty horsemen, and ten chariots, and ten thousand footmen; for the king of Syria had destroyed them, and had made them like the dust by threshing.* For there was not left to Jehoahaz an army of more than fifty horsemen and ten chariots and ten thousand foot soldiers, for the king of Syria had destroyed them and made them like the dust at threshing.
- 8 *Now the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz, and all that he did, and his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz and all that he did. His might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 9 *And Jehoahaz slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria: and Joash his son reigned in his stead.* So Jehoahaz slept with his fathers. They buried him in Samaria, and Joash his son reigned in his place.
- 10 *In the thirty and seventh year of Joash king of Judah began Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned sixteen years.* In the thirty-seventh year of Joash king of Judah, Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz began to reign over Israel in Samaria. He reigned sixteen years.
- 11 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD; he departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel sin: but he walked therein.* He also did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. He did not depart from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin. But He walked in them.
- 12 *And the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, and his might wherewith he fought against Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Joash and all that he did, and the might with which He fought against Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?

- 13 *And Joash slept with his fathers; and Jeroboam sat upon his throne: and Joash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel.* So Joash slept with his fathers, and Jeroboam sat on his throne. And Joash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel.
- 14 *Now Elisha was fallen sick of his sickness whereof he died. And Joash the king of Israel came down unto him, and wept over his face, and said, O my father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the horsemen thereof.* Now when Elisha had fallen sick with the illness of which he was to die, Joash king of Israel went down to him and wept before him, saying, "My father, my father! The chariots of Israel and its horsemen!"
- 15 *And Elisha said unto him, Take bow and arrows. And he took unto him bow and arrows.* Elisha said to him, "Take a bow and arrows." So he took a bow and arrows.
- 16 *And he said to the king of Israel, Put thine hand upon the bow. And he put his hand upon it: and Elisha put his hands upon the king's hands.* Then he said to the king of Israel, "Draw the bow," and he drew it. And Elisha laid his hands on the king's hands.
- 17 *And he said, Open the window eastward. And he opened it. Then Elisha said, Shoot. And he shot. And he said, The arrow of the LORD'S deliverance, and the arrow of deliverance from Syria: for thou shalt smite the Syrians in Aphek, till thou have consumed them.* He said, "Open the window eastward," and He opened it. Then Elisha said, "Shoot," and he shot. And he said, "The LORD's arrow of victory, the arrow of victory over Syria! For You shall fight the Syrians in Aphek until You have made an end of them."
- 18 *And he said, Take the arrows. And he took them. And he said unto the king of Israel, Smite upon the ground. And he smote thrice, and stayed.* He said, "Take the arrows," and he took them. And he said to the king of Israel, "Strike the ground with them." And he struck three times and stopped.
- 19 *And the man of God was wroth with him, and said, Thou shouldest have smitten five or six times; then hadst thou smitten Syria till thou hadst consumed it: whereas now thou shalt smite Syria but thrice.* Then the man of God was angry with Him and said, "You should have struck five or six times; then you would have struck down Syria until you had made an end of it. But now you will strike down Syria only three times."

- 20 *And Elisha died, and they buried him. And the bands of the Moabites invaded the land at the coming in of the year.* So Elisha died. They buried him. Now bands of Moabites used to invade the land in the spring of the year.
- 21 *And it came to pass, as they were burying a man, that, behold, they spied a band of men; and they cast the man into the sepulchre of Elisha: and when the man was let down, and touched the bones of Elisha, he revived, and stood up on his feet.* As a man was being buried, a marauding band was seen and the man was thrown into the grave of Elisha, and as soon as the man touched the bones of Elisha, he revived and stood on his feet.
- 22 *But Hazael king of Syria oppressed Israel all the days of Jehoahaz.* Now Hazael king of Syria oppressed Israel all the days of Jehoahaz.
- 23 *And the LORD was gracious unto them, and had compassion on them, and had respect unto them, because of his covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and would not destroy them, neither cast he them from his presence as yet.* But the LORD was gracious to them and had compassion on them. He turned toward them, because of His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and would not destroy them, nor has he cast them from His presence until now.
- 24 *So Hazael king of Syria died; and Benhadad his son reigned in his stead.* When Hazael king of Syria died, Ben-hadad His son became king in His place.
- 25 *And Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz took again out of the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael the cities, which he had taken out of the hand of Jehoahaz his father by war. Three times did Joash beat him, and recovered the cities of Israel.* Then Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz took again from Ben-hadad the son of Hazael the cities that He had taken from Jehoahaz his father in war. Three times Joash defeated him and recovered the cities of Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Kgs 13:24-25; 1 Kgs 19:17
- v4 — 2 Kgs 14:26; Ex 3:7; Ps 78:34
- v6 — 1 Kgs 16:33
- v14 — 2 Kgs 2:12; Phil 2:26; Gen 48:1; 2 Kgs 20:1; John 11:3
- v17 — 1 Kgs 20:26
- v19 — 2 Kgs 13:25
- v20 — 2 Kgs 24:2
- v21 — Ezek 37:1-10; John 5:28-29; Acts 19:12; 2 Kgs 4:35; John 5:25
- v22 — 2 Kgs 8:12
- v23 — Ps 105:8; 2 Kgs 14:27; Mic 7:18-20; Ex 2:24-25; Ps 86:15
- v25 — 2 Kgs 13:18-19

Amaziah of Judah — 796–767 BC

Jeroboam II of Israel — 782–753 BC

Chapter 14

Amaziah of Judah defeated Edom but then challenged Jehoash of Israel and was defeated at the battle of Beth-shemesh; Jerusalem's wall was broken and the temple plundered. Jeroboam II reigned in Israel and restored its borders as the prophet Jonah had spoken.

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| 1 | <i>In the second year of Joash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel reigned Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah.</i> | In the second year of Joash the son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel, Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, began to reign. |
| 2 | <i>He was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.</i> | He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jehoaddin of Jerusalem. |
| 3 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, yet not like David his father: he did according to all things as Joash his father did.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, yet not like David his father. He did in all things as Joash his father had done. |

- 4 *Howbeit the high places were not taken away: as yet the people did sacrifice and burnt incense on the high places.* But the high places were not removed; the people still sacrificed and made offerings on the high places.
- 5 *And it came to pass, as soon as the kingdom was confirmed in his hand, that he slew his servants which had slain the king his father.* As soon as the royal power was firmly in his hand, he struck down his servants who had struck down the king his father.
- 6 *But the children of the murderers he slew not: according unto that which is written in the book of the law of Moses, wherein the LORD commanded, saying, The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, nor the children be put to death for the fathers; but every man shall be put to death for his own sin.* But He did not put to death the children of the murderers, according to what is written in the Book of the Law of Moses, where the LORD commanded, "Fathers shall not be put to death because of their children, nor shall children be put to death because of their fathers. But each one shall die for his own sin."
- 7 *He slew of Edom in the valley of salt ten thousand, and took Selah by war, and called the name of it Joktheel unto this day.* He struck down ten thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt and took Sela by storm, and called it Joktheel, which is its name to this day.
- 8 *Then Amaziah sent messengers to Jehoash, the son of Jehoahaz son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, Come, let us look one another in the face.* Then Amaziah sent messengers to Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz, son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, "Come, let us face one another in battle."
- 9 *And Jehoash the king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, Give thy daughter to my son to wife: and there passed by a wild beast that was in Lebanon, and trode down the thistle.* Jehoash king of Israel sent word to Amaziah king of Judah, "A thistle on Lebanon sent to a cedar on Lebanon, saying, 'Give your daughter to my son for a wife,' and a wild beast of Lebanon passed by and trampled down the thistle.

- 10 *Thou hast indeed smitten Edom, and thine heart hath lifted thee up: glory of this, and tarry at home: for why shouldest thou meddle to thy hurt, that thou shouldest fall, even thou, and Judah with thee?* You have indeed struck down Edom, and your heart has lifted you up. Be content with your glory, and stay at home, for why should you provoke trouble so that you fall, you and Judah with you?"
- 11 *But Amaziah would not hear. Therefore Jehoash king of Israel went up; and he and Amaziah king of Judah looked one another in the face at Bethshemesh, which belongeth to Judah.* But Amaziah would not listen. So Jehoash king of Israel went up. He and Amaziah king of Judah faced one another in battle at Beth-shemesh, which belongs to Judah.
- 12 *And Judah was put to the worse before Israel; and they fled every man to their tents.* Judah was defeated by Israel, and every man fled to his home.
- 13 *And Jehoash king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Jehoash the son of Ahaziah, at Bethshemesh, and came to Jerusalem, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim unto the corner gate, four hundred cubits.* Jehoash king of Israel captured Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Jehoash, son of Ahaziah, at Beth-shemesh, and came to Jerusalem and broke down the wall of Jerusalem for four hundred cubits, from the Ephraim Gate to the Corner Gate.
- 14 *And he took all the gold and silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house, and hostages, and returned to Samaria.* He seized all the gold and silver. All the vessels that were found in the house of the LORD and in the treasuries of the king's house, also hostages. He returned to Samaria.
- 15 *Now the rest of the acts of Jehoash which he did, and his might, and how he fought with Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Jehoash that He did. His might, and how He fought with Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?

- 16 *And Jehoash slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel; and Jeroboam his son reigned in his stead.* Jehoash slept with his fathers and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel, and Jeroboam his son reigned in his place.
- 17 *And Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah lived after the death of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel fifteen years.* Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, lived fifteen years after the death of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel.
- 18 *And the rest of the acts of Amaziah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 19 *Now they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem: and he fled to Lachish; but they sent after him to Lachish, and slew him there.* They made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem. He fled to Lachish. But they sent after him to Lachish and killed him there.
- 20 *And they brought him on horses: and he was buried at Jerusalem with his fathers in the city of David.* They brought him on horses. He was buried in Jerusalem with his fathers in the city of David.
- 21 *And all the people of Judah took Azariah, which was sixteen years old, and made him king instead of his father Amaziah.* All the people of Judah took Azariah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king instead of his father Amaziah.
- 22 *He built Elath, and restored it to Judah, after that the king slept with his fathers.* He built Elath and restored it to Judah, after the king slept with his fathers.
- 23 *In the fifteenth year of Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel began to reign in Samaria, and reigned forty and one years.* In the fifteenth year of Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel, began to reign in Samaria. He reigned forty-one years.
- 24 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. He did not depart from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin.

- 25 *He restored the coast of Israel from the entering of Hamath unto the sea of the plain, according to the word of the LORD God of Israel, which he spake by the hand of his servant Jonah, the son of Amittai, the prophet, which was of Gathhepher.* He restored the border of Israel from the entering of Hamath as far as the sea of the plain, according to the word of the LORD, the God of Israel, which He spoke by His servant Jonah the son of Amittai, the prophet, who was from Gath-hepher.
- 26 *For the LORD saw the affliction of Israel, that it was very bitter: for there was not any shut up, nor any left, nor any helper for Israel.* For the LORD saw that the affliction of Israel was very bitter, for there was none left, bond or free, and there was none to help Israel.
- 27 *And the LORD said not that he would blot out the name of Israel from under heaven: but he saved them by the hand of Jeroboam the son of Joash.* But the LORD had not said that He would blot out the name of Israel from under heaven, so He saved them by the hand of Jeroboam the son of Joash.
- 28 *Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, and all that he did, and his might, how he warred, and how he recovered Damascus, and Hamath, which belonged to Judah, for Israel, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam and all that he did. His might, how he fought, and how he restored Damascus and Hamath to Judah in Israel, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 29 *And Jeroboam slept with his fathers, even with the kings of Israel; and Zachariah his son reigned in his stead.* Jeroboam slept with his fathers, the kings of Israel, and Zechariah his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

Selah (*SEE-lah*) — A musical or liturgical pause marker in the Psalms — likely a signal to stop and reflect, or a rest in the music.

Cross-References:

- v4 — 2 Kgs 12:3
- v6 — Deut 24:16; Ezek 18:20; Ezek 18:4; Jer 31:30
- v7 — 2 Sam 8:13
- v9 — Judg 9:8-15

v10 — 2 Chr 26:16; Deut 8:14
v13 — Neh 8:16
v22 — 2 Kgs 16:6; 1 Kgs 9:26
v25 — Deut 3:17
v26 — Deut 32:36
v27 — 2 Kgs 13:23
v28 — 1 Kgs 11:24
Uzziah (Azariah) of Judah — 767–740 BC
Zechariah of Israel — 753 BC
Shallum of Israel — 752 BC
Menahem of Israel — 752–742 BC
Pekahiah of Israel — 742–740 BC
Pekah of Israel — 740–732 BC
Jotham of Judah — 740–732 BC

Chapter 15

Azariah (Uzziah) reigned fifty-two years in Judah but was struck with leprosy. In Israel, a rapid succession of kings followed—Zechariah, Shallum, Menahem, Pekahiah, and Pekah—most seizing the throne by assassination; Tiglath-pileser of Assyria carried away the northern territories.

1 <i>In the twenty and seventh year of Jeroboam king of Israel began Azariah son of Amaziah king of Judah to reign.</i>	<i>In the twenty-seventh year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Azariah the son of Amaziah, king of Judah, began to reign.</i>
2 <i>Sixteen years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned two and fifty years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jecholiah of Jerusalem.</i>	<i>He was sixteen years old when he began to reign. He reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jecoliah of Jerusalem.</i>
3 <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Amaziah had done;</i>	<i>He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that His father Amaziah had done.</i>

- 4 *Save that the high places were not removed: the people sacrificed and burnt incense still on the high places.* Nevertheless, the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and made offerings on the high places.
- 5 *And the LORD smote the king, so that he was a leper unto the day of his death, and dwelt in a several house. And Jotham the king's son was over the house, judging the people of the land.* The LORD struck the king, so that he was a leper to the day of his death. He lived in a separate house. And Jotham the king's son was over the household, governing the people of the land.
- 6 *And the rest of the acts of Azariah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Azariah. All that He did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 7 *So Azariah slept with his fathers; and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David: and Jotham his son reigned in his stead.* Azariah slept with his fathers. They buried him with his fathers in the city of David, and Jotham his son reigned in his place.
- 8 *In the thirty and eighth year of Azariah king of Judah did Zachariah the son of Jeroboam reign over Israel in Samaria six months.* In the thirty-eighth year of Azariah king of Judah, Zechariah the son of Jeroboam reigned over Israel in Samaria six months.
- 9 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as his fathers had done: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, as His fathers had done. He did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin.
- 10 *And Shallum the son of Jabesh conspired against him, and smote him before the people, and slew him, and reigned in his stead.* Shallum the son of Jabesh conspired against him and struck Him down at Ibleam and put Him to death and reigned in His place.
- 11 *And the rest of the acts of Zachariah, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Zechariah, they are written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

- 12 *This was the word of the LORD which he spake unto Jehu, saying, Thy sons shall sit on the throne of Israel unto the fourth generation. And so it came to pass.* This was the word of the LORD that He spoke to Jehu, "Your sons shall sit on the throne of Israel to the fourth generation." And so it came to pass.
- 13 *Shallum the son of Jabesh began to reign in the nine and thirtieth year of Uzziah king of Judah; and he reigned a full month in Samaria.* Shallum the son of Jabesh began to reign in the thirty-ninth year of Uzziah king of Judah. He reigned one month in Samaria.
- 14 *For Menahem the son of Gadi went up from Tirzah, and came to Samaria, and smote Shallum the son of Jabesh in Samaria, and slew him, and reigned in his stead.* Then Menahem the son of Gadi came up from Tirzah and came to Samaria. He struck down Shallum the son of Jabesh in Samaria and put him to death and reigned in his place.
- 15 *And the rest of the acts of Shallum, and his conspiracy which he made, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Shallum, and the conspiracy that he made, they are written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 16 *Then Menahem smote Tiphseh, and all that were therein, and the coasts thereof from Tirzah: because they opened not to him, therefore he smote it; and all the women therein that were with child he ripped up.* At that time Menahem struck Tiphseh and all who were in it and its territory from Tirzah on, because they did not open it to him. Therefore he struck it. He ripped open all the women in it who were pregnant.
- 17 *In the nine and thirtieth year of Azariah king of Judah began Menahem the son of Gadi to reign over Israel, and reigned ten years in Samaria.* In the thirty-ninth year of Azariah king of Judah, Menahem the son of Gadi began to reign over Israel. He reigned ten years in Samaria.
- 18 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not all his days from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. He did not depart all His days from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin.

- 19 *And Pul the king of Assyria came against the land: and Menahem gave Pul a thousand talents of silver, that his hand might be with him to confirm the kingdom in his hand.* Pul the king of Assyria came against the land, and Menahem gave Pul a thousand talents of silver, that he might help him to confirm his hold on the royal power.
- 20 *And Menahem exacted the money of Israel, even of all the mighty men of wealth, of each man fifty shekels of silver, to give to the king of Assyria. So the king of Assyria turned back, and stayed not there in the land.* Menahem exacted the money from Israel, that is, from all the wealthy men, fifty shekels of silver from every man, to give to the king of Assyria. So the king of Assyria turned back and did not stay there in the land.
- 21 *And the rest of the acts of Menahem, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?* Now the rest of the acts of Menahem and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?
- 22 *And Menahem slept with his fathers; and Pekahiah his son reigned in his stead.* Menahem slept with his fathers, and Pekahiah his son reigned in his place.
- 23 *In the fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah Pekahiah the son of Menahem began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned two years.* In the fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah, Pekahiah the son of Menahem began to reign over Israel in Samaria. He reigned two years.
- 24 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. He did not turn away from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin.
- 25 *But Pekah the son of Remaliah, a captain of his, conspired against him, and smote him in Samaria, in the palace of the king's house, with Argob and Arieah, and with him fifty men of the Gileadites: and he killed him, and reigned in his room.* Pekah the son of Remaliah, his captain, conspired against him with fifty men of the people of Gilead, and struck him down in Samaria, in the citadel of the king's house; he put him to death and reigned in his place.

- 26 *And the rest of the acts of Pekahiah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Pekahiah and all that he did, they are written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 27 *In the two and fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah Pekah the son of Remaliah began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned twenty years.* In the fifty-second year of Azariah king of Judah, Pekah the son of Remaliah began to reign over Israel in Samaria. He reigned twenty years.
- 28 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD. He did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which he made Israel to sin.
- 29 *In the days of Pekah king of Israel came Tiglathpileser king of Assyria, and took Ijon, and Abelbethmaachah, and Janoah, and Kedesh, and Hazor, and Gilead, and Galilee, all the land of Naphtali, and carried them captive to Assyria.* In the days of Pekah king of Israel, Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria came and captured Ijon, Abel-beth-maacah, Janoah, Kedesh, Hazor, Gilead, and Galilee, all the land of Naphtali. He carried the people captive to Assyria.
- 30 *And Hoshea the son of Elah made a conspiracy against Pekah the son of Remaliah, and smote him, and slew him, and reigned in his stead, in the twentieth year of Jotham the son of Uzziah.* Then Hoshea the son of Elah made a conspiracy against Pekah the son of Remaliah and struck him down and put him to death and reigned in his place, in the twentieth year of Jotham the son of Uzziah.
- 31 *And the rest of the acts of Pekah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Pekah and all that he did, they are written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 32 *In the second year of Pekah the son of Remaliah king of Israel began Jotham the son of Uzziah king of Judah to reign.* In the second year of Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, Jotham the son of Uzziah, king of Judah, began to reign.

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| <p>33 <i>Five and twenty years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jerusha, the daughter of Zadok.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD: he did according to all that his father Uzziah had done.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Howbeit the high places were not removed: the people sacrificed and burned incense still in the high places. He built the higher gate of the house of the LORD.</i></p> <p>36 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i></p> <p>37 <i>In those days the LORD began to send against Judah Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekah the son of Remaliah.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And Jotham slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Ahaz his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jerusha the daughter of Zadok.</p> <p>He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that His father Uzziah had done.</p> <p>Nevertheless, the high places were not removed. The people still sacrificed and made offerings on the high places. He built the upper gate of the house of the LORD.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Jotham and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> <p>In those days the LORD began to send Rezin the king of Syria and Pekah the son of Remaliah against Judah.</p> <p>Jotham slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father, and Ahaz his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Abel (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

v5 — Lev 13:46

v12 — 2 Kgs 10:30

v14 — 1 Kgs 14:17

v16 — 2 Kgs 8:12

v29 — 1 Chr 5:26; 2 Kgs 17:6

v34 — 2 Chr 26:4-5

v37 — 2 Kgs 16:5; Isa 7:1

Ahaz of Judah — 732–715 BC

Chapter 16

Ahaz of Judah walked in the ways of the kings of Israel and sacrificed his son in the fire. When Syria and Israel attacked, Ahaz bribed Tiglath-pileser of Assyria for help and replaced the bronze altar of the LORD with a copy of a pagan altar from Damascus.

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| <p>1 <i>In the seventeenth year of Pekah the son of Remaliah Ahaz the son of Jotham king of Judah began to reign.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Twenty years old was Ahaz when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem, and did not that which was right in the sight of the LORD his God, like David his father.</i></p> <p>3 <i>But he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, yea, and made his son to pass through the fire, according to the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out from before the children of Israel.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And he sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Then Rezin king of Syria and Pekah son of Remaliah king of Israel came up to Jerusalem to war: and they besieged Ahaz, but could not overcome him.</i></p> | <p>In the seventeenth year of Pekah the son of Remaliah, Ahaz the son of Jotham, king of Judah, began to reign.</p> <p>Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign. He reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. And He did not do what was right in the eyes of the LORD His God, as His father David had done,</p> <p>But He walked in the way of the kings of Israel. He even burned His son as an offering, according to the despicable practices of the nations whom the LORD drove out before the people of Israel.</p> <p>He sacrificed and made offerings on the high places and on the hills and under every green tree.</p> <p>Then Rezin king of Syria and Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, came up to wage war on Jerusalem. They besieged Ahaz but could not conquer him.</p> |
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- 6 *At that time Rezin king of Syria recovered Elath to Syria, and drove the Jews from Elath: and the Syrians came to Elath, and dwelt there unto this day.* At that time Rezin king of Syria recovered Elath for Syria and drove the Jews from Elath, and the Syrians came to Elath, where they live to this day.
- 7 *So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglathpileser king of Assyria, saying, I am thy servant and thy son: come up, and save me out of the hand of the king of Syria, and out of the hand of the king of Israel, which rise up against me.* So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, saying, "I am your servant and your son. Come up and rescue me from the hand of the king of Syria and from the hand of the king of Israel, who are attacking me."
- 8 *And Ahaz took the silver and gold that was found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house, and sent it for a present to the king of Assyria.* Ahaz also took the silver and gold that was found in the house of the LORD and in the treasures of the king's house and sent a present to the king of Assyria.
- 9 *And the king of Assyria hearkened unto him: for the king of Assyria went up against Damascus, and took it, and carried the people of it captive to Kir, and slew Rezin.* The king of Assyria listened to him. The king of Assyria marched up against Damascus and took it, carrying its people captive to Kir. He killed Rezin.
- 10 *And king Ahaz went to Damascus to meet Tiglathpileser king of Assyria, and saw an altar that was at Damascus: and king Ahaz sent to Urijah the priest the fashion of the altar, and the pattern of it, according to all the workmanship thereof.* When King Ahaz went to Damascus to meet Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, he saw the altar that was at Damascus. And King Ahaz sent to Uriah the priest a model of the altar, and its pattern, exact in all its details.
- 11 *And Urijah the priest built an altar according to all that king Ahaz had sent from Damascus: so Urijah the priest made it against king Ahaz came from Damascus.* Uriah the priest built the altar; in accordance with all that King Ahaz had sent from Damascus, so Uriah the priest made it, before King Ahaz arrived from Damascus.

- 12 *And when the king was come from Damascus, the king saw the altar: and the king approached to the altar, and offered thereon.* When the king came from Damascus, the king viewed the altar. Then the king drew near to the altar and went up on it
- 13 *And he burnt his burnt offering and his meat offering, and poured his drink offering, and sprinkled the blood of his peace offerings, upon the altar.* Burned his burnt offering and his grain offering and poured his drink offering and threw the blood of his peace offerings against the altar.
- 14 *And he brought also the brasen altar, which was before the LORD, from the forefront of the house, from between the altar and the house of the LORD, and put it on the north side of the altar.* The bronze altar that was before the LORD He removed from the front of the house, from the place between His altar and the house of the LORD, and put it on the north side of His altar.
- 15 *And king Ahaz commanded Urijah the priest, saying, Upon the great altar burn the morning burnt offering, and the evening meat offering, and the king's burnt sacrifice, and his meat offering, with the burnt offering of all the people of the land, and their meat offering, and their drink offerings; and sprinkle upon it all the blood of the burnt offering, and all the blood of the sacrifice: and the brasen altar shall be for me to enquire by.* King Ahaz commanded Uriah the priest, saying, "On the great altar burn the morning burnt offering and the evening grain offering and the king's burnt offering and his grain offering, with the burnt offering of all the people of the land. Their grain offering and their drink offering. And throw against it all the blood of the burnt offering and all the blood of the sacrifice, but the bronze altar shall be for me to inquire by."
- 16 *Thus did Urijah the priest, according to all that king Ahaz commanded.* Uriah the priest did all this, as King Ahaz commanded.
- 17 *And king Ahaz cut off the borders of the bases, and removed the laver from off them; and took down the sea from off the brasen oxen that were under it, and put it upon a pavement of stones.* King Ahaz cut off the frames of the stands and removed the basin from them. He took down the sea from off the bronze oxen that were under it and put it on a stone pedestal.

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| <p>18 <i>And the covert for the sabbath that they had built in the house, and the king's entry without, turned he from the house of the LORD for the king of Assyria.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Ahaz which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i></p> <p>20 <i>And Ahaz slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David: and Hezekiah his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>The covered way for the Sabbath that had been built inside the house and the outer entrance for the king he caused to go around the house of the LORD, because of the king of Assyria.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Ahaz that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> <p>Ahaz slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

laver (*LAY-ver*) — The large bronze basin in the tabernacle courtyard — priests washed their hands and feet here before approaching God's altar.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Cross-References:

v3 — Deut 12:31; Lev 18:21

v4 — Deut 12:2

v5 — 2 Kgs 15:37

v6 — 2 Kgs 14:22

v7 — 2 Kgs 15:29

v9 — Amos 9:7; Isa 22:6

v14 — 2 Chr 4:1

v15 — Ex 29:39-41

THE ASSYRIAN PERIOD ENDS — 612 BC

For nearly three centuries Assyria has dominated the ancient Near East — its armies the most feared on earth, its capital Nineveh the largest city in the world. In 722 BC the Assyrians scattered the northern kingdom of Israel, dragging its ten tribes into exile. But now Nineveh itself has fallen — destroyed by Babylon and the Medes — and the empire that broke Israel lies in ruins. The chapter you are about to read recounts how the northern kingdom came to that

end. A power vacuum opens across the world, and Babylon is rising to fill it.

Hoshea of Israel — 732–722 BC (last king of Israel)

Chapter 17

Hoshea, the last king of Israel, was conquered by Shalmaneser of Assyria, and Samaria fell after a three-year siege. The people of Israel were carried into exile because they had forsaken the LORD and served other gods; foreign peoples were settled in their land.

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| 1 | <i>In the twelfth year of Ahaz king of Judah began Hoshea the son of Elah to reign in Samaria over Israel nine years.</i> | In the twelfth year of Ahaz king of Judah, Hoshea the son of Elah began to reign in Samaria over Israel. He reigned nine years. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, but not as the kings of Israel that were before him.</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, yet not as the kings of Israel who were before Him. |
| 3 | <i>Against him came up Shalmaneser king of Assyria; and Hoshea became his servant, and gave him presents.</i> | Against Him came up Shalmaneser king of Assyria. And Hoshea became his vassal and paid him tribute. |
| 4 | <i>And the king of Assyria found conspiracy in Hoshea: for he had sent messengers to So king of Egypt, and brought no present to the king of Assyria, as he had done year by year: therefore the king of Assyria shut him up, and bound him in prison.</i> | But the king of Assyria found treachery in Hoshea, for he had sent messengers to So, king of Egypt, and offered no tribute to the king of Assyria, as he had done year by year. Therefore the king of Assyria imprisoned him and bound him in prison. |
| 5 | <i>Then the king of Assyria came up throughout all the land, and went up to Samaria, and besieged it three years.</i> | Then the king of Assyria invaded all the land and came to Samaria, and for three years he besieged it. |

- 6 *In the ninth year of Hoshea the king of Assyria took Samaria, and carried Israel away into Assyria, and placed them in Halah and in Habor by the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes.* In the ninth year of Hoshea, the king of Assyria captured Samaria. He carried the Israelites away to Assyria and placed them in Halah, and on the Habor, the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes.
- 7 *For so it was, that the children of Israel had sinned against the LORD their God, which had brought them up out of the land of Egypt, from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and had feared other gods,* This occurred because the people of Israel had sinned against the LORD their God, Who had brought them up out of the land of Egypt from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and had feared other gods
- 8 *And walked in the statutes of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out from before the children of Israel, and of the kings of Israel, which they had made.* Walked in the customs of the nations whom the LORD drove out before the people of Israel, and in the customs that the kings of Israel had practiced.
- 9 *And the children of Israel did secretly those things that were not right against the LORD their God, and they built them high places in all their cities, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.* The people of Israel did secretly against the LORD their God things that were not right. They built for themselves high places in all their towns, from watchtower to fortified city.
- 10 *And they set them up images and groves in every high hill, and under every green tree:* They set up for themselves images and groves on every high hill and under every green tree,
- 11 *And there they burnt incense in all the high places, as did the heathen whom the LORD carried away before them; and wrought wicked things to provoke the LORD to anger:* There they made offerings on all the high places, as the nations did whom the LORD carried away before them. And they did wicked things, provoking the LORD to anger,
- 12 *For they served idols, whereof the LORD had said unto them, Ye shall not do this thing.* They served idols, of which the LORD had said to them, "You shall not do this."

- 13 *Yet the LORD testified against Israel, and against Judah, by all the prophets, and by all the seers, saying, Turn ye from your evil ways, and keep my commandments and my statutes, according to all the law which I commanded your fathers, and which I sent to you by my servants the prophets.* Yet the LORD warned Israel and Judah by every prophet and every seer, saying, "Turn from Your evil ways and keep my commandments and my statutes, in accordance with all the Law that I commanded Your fathers, and that I sent to You by my servants the prophets."
- 14 *Notwithstanding they would not hear, but hardened their necks, like to the neck of their fathers, that did not believe in the LORD their God.* But they would not listen, but were stubborn, as their fathers had been, who did not believe in the LORD their God.
- 15 *And they rejected his statutes, and his covenant that he made with their fathers, and his testimonies which he testified against them; and they followed vanity, and became vain, and went after the heathen that were round about them, concerning whom the LORD had charged them, that they should not do like them.* They despised His statutes and His covenant that He made with their fathers and the warnings that He gave them. They went after false idols and became false. They followed the nations that were around them, concerning whom the LORD had commanded them that they should not do as they did.
- 16 *And they left all the commandments of the LORD their God, and made them molten images, even two calves, and made a grove, and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served Baal.* They abandoned all the commandments of the LORD their God, and made for themselves metal images of two calves. They made a grove and worshiped all the host of heaven and served Baal.
- 17 *And they caused their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire, and used divination and enchantments, and sold themselves to do evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.* They burned their sons and their daughters as offerings and used divination and omens and sold themselves to do evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger.

- 18 *Therefore the LORD was very angry with Israel, and removed them out of his sight: there was none left but the tribe of Judah only.* Therefore the LORD was very angry with Israel and removed them out of His sight. None was left but the tribe of Judah only.
- 19 *Also Judah kept not the commandments of the LORD their God, but walked in the statutes of Israel which they made.* Judah also did not keep the commandments of the LORD their God, but walked in the customs that Israel had introduced.
- 20 *And the LORD rejected all the seed of Israel, and afflicted them, and delivered them into the hand of spoilers, until he had cast them out of his sight.* The LORD rejected all the descendants of Israel and afflicted them and gave them into the hand of plunderers, until He had cast them out of His sight.
- 21 *For he rent Israel from the house of David; and they made Jeroboam the son of Nebat king: and Jeroboam drave Israel from following the LORD, and made them sin a great sin.* When He had torn Israel from the house of David, they made Jeroboam the son of Nebat king. And Jeroboam drove Israel from following the LORD and made them commit great sin.
- 22 *For the children of Israel walked in all the sins of Jeroboam which he did; they departed not from them;* The people of Israel walked in all the sins that Jeroboam did. They did not depart from them,
- 23 *Until the LORD removed Israel out of his sight, as he had said by all his servants the prophets. So was Israel carried away out of their own land to Assyria unto this day.* Until the LORD removed Israel out of His sight, as He had spoken by all His servants the prophets. So Israel was exiled from their own land to Assyria until this day.
- 24 *And the king of Assyria brought men from Babylon, and from Cuthah, and from Ava, and from Hamath, and from Sepharvaim, and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the children of Israel: and they possessed Samaria, and dwelt in the cities thereof.* The king of Assyria brought people from Babylon, Cuthah, Avva, Hamath, and Sepharvaim, and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the people of Israel. And they took possession of Samaria and lived in its cities.

- 25 *And so it was at the beginning of their dwelling there, that they feared not the LORD: therefore the LORD sent lions among them, which slew some of them.* At the beginning of their dwelling there, they did not fear the LORD. Therefore the LORD sent lions among them, which killed some of them.
- 26 *Wherefore they spake to the king of Assyria, saying, The nations which thou hast removed, and placed in the cities of Samaria, know not the manner of the God of the land: therefore he hath sent lions among them, and, behold, they slay them, because they know not the manner of the God of the land.* So the king of Assyria was told, "The nations that you have carried away and placed in the cities of Samaria do not know the law of the god of the land. Therefore He has sent lions among them. They are killing them, because they do not know the law of the god of the land."
- 27 *Then the king of Assyria commanded, saying, Carry thither one of the priests whom ye brought from thence; and let them go and dwell there, and let him teach them the manner of the God of the land.* Then the king of Assyria commanded, "Send there one of the priests whom you carried away from there, and let him go and dwell there and teach them the law of the god of the land."
- 28 *Then one of the priests whom they had carried away from Samaria came and dwelt in Bethel, and taught them how they should fear the LORD.* So one of the priests whom they had carried away from Samaria came and lived in Bethel and taught them how they should fear the LORD.
- 29 *Howbeit every nation made gods of their own, and put them in the houses of the high places which the Samaritans had made, every nation in their cities wherein they dwelt.* But every nation still made gods of its own and put them in the shrines of the high places that the Samaritans had made, every nation in the cities in which they lived.
- 30 *And the men of Babylon made Succothbenoth, and the men of Cuth made Nergal, and the men of Hamath made Ashima,* The men of Babylon made Succoth-benoth, the men of Cuth made Nergal, the men of Hamath made Ashima,

- 31 *And the Avites made Nibhaz and Tartak, and the Sepharvites burnt their children in fire to Adrammelech and Anammelech, the gods of Sepharvaim.* The Avvites made Nibhaz and Tartak. The Sepharvites burned their children in the fire to Adrammelech and Anammelech, the gods of Sepharvaim.
- 32 *So they feared the LORD, and made unto themselves of the lowest of them priests of the high places, which sacrificed for them in the houses of the high places.* They also feared the LORD and appointed from among themselves all sorts of people as priests of the high places, who sacrificed for them in the shrines of the high places.
- 33 *They feared the LORD, and served their own gods, after the manner of the nations whom they carried away from thence.* So they feared the LORD but also served their own gods, after the manner of the nations from among whom they had been carried away.
- 34 *Unto this day they do after the former manners: they fear not the LORD, neither do they after their statutes, or after their ordinances, or after the law and commandment which the LORD commanded the children of Jacob, whom he named Israel;* To this day they do according to the former manner. They do not fear the LORD. They do not follow the statutes or the rules or the law or the commandment that the LORD commanded the children of Jacob, whom he named Israel.
- 35 *With whom the LORD had made a covenant, and charged them, saying, Ye shall not fear other gods, nor bow yourselves to them, nor serve them, nor sacrifice to them:* The LORD made a covenant with them and commanded them, "You shall not fear other gods or bow yourselves to them or serve them or sacrifice to them,
- 36 *But the LORD, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt with great power and a stretched out arm, him shall ye fear, and him shall ye worship, and to him shall ye do sacrifice.* But You shall fear the LORD, Who brought You out of the land of Egypt with great power and with an outstretched arm. You shall bow yourselves to Him, and to Him You shall sacrifice.

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| <p>37 <i>And the statutes, and the ordinances, and the law, and the commandment, which he wrote for you, ye shall observe to do for evermore; and ye shall not fear other gods.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And the covenant that I have made with you ye shall not forget; neither shall ye fear other gods.</i></p> <p>39 <i>But the LORD your God ye shall fear; and he shall deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies.</i></p> <p>40 <i>Howbeit they did not hearken, but they did after their former manner.</i></p> <p>41 <i>So these nations feared the LORD, and served their graven images, both their children, and their children's children: as did their fathers, so do they unto this day.</i></p> | <p>The statutes and the rules and the law and the commandment that He wrote for You, You shall always be careful to do. You shall not fear other gods,</p> <p>You shall not forget the covenant that I have made with You. You shall not fear other gods,</p> <p>But You shall fear the LORD Your God. He will deliver You out of the hand of all Your enemies."</p> <p>However, they would not listen. But they did according to their former manner.</p> <p>So these nations feared the LORD and also served their carved images. Their children did likewise. Their children's children—as their fathers did, so they do to this day.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Samaritans (*sah-MEHR-ih-tanz*) — People of mixed descent who lived in Samaria after the Assyrian conquest — Jews despised them as half-breeds who had corrupted their religion; Jesus's parable of the Good Samaritan shocked His audience.

Cross-References:

- v6** — Hos 13:16; 1 Chr 5:26; Deut 28:64
v8 — 2 Kgs 16:3; Lev 18:3; Deut 18:9
v10 — 1 Kgs 14:23; Mic 5:14; 2 Kgs 16:4; Ex 34:13
v13 — 1 Sam 9:9; Jer 35:15
v15 — Deut 12:30-31; Deut 32:21; Rom 1:21-23; Jer 2:5
v16 — 1 Kgs 12:28; 1 Kgs 14:15; 1 Kgs 16:31; 1 Kgs 14:23
v17 — 2 Kgs 21:6; 2 Kgs 16:3; Ezek 23:37; 1 Kgs 21:20; Deut 18:10-12
v18 — 1 Kgs 12:20; 1 Kgs 11:13
v23 — 2 Kgs 17:6; 2 Kgs 17:13
v33 — 2 Kgs 17:41; Luke 16:13; Matt 6:24
v34 — Gen 32:28; Gen 35:10
v41 — Matt 6:24; 1 Kgs 18:21; Zeph 1:5; 2 Kgs 17:32-33

Hezekiah of Judah — 715–686 BC

Chapter 18

Hezekiah became king of Judah and did what was right, removing the high places and breaking the bronze serpent. He rebelled against Assyria; Sennacherib invaded Judah and sent the Rabshakeh to Jerusalem demanding surrender and mocking the LORD.

- 1

Now it came to pass in the third year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, that Hezekiah the son of Ahaz king of Judah began to reign.
- In the third year of Hoshea son of Elah, king of Israel, Hezekiah the son of Ahaz, king of Judah, began to reign.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hezekiah** (hez-eh-KY-ah) — "the LORD strengthens" — One of Judah's greatest kings, who purified the temple, destroyed the high places and the bronze serpent, and trusted the LORD against the Assyrian invasion. God added fifteen years to his life. He reigned twenty-nine years.

- 2

Twenty and five years old was he when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Abi, the daughter of Zachariah.
- He was twenty-five years old when He began to reign. He reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abi the daughter of Zechariah.
- 3

And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that David his father did.
- He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that David his father had done.
- 4

He removed the high places, and brake the images, and cut down the groves, and brake in pieces the brasen serpent that Moses had made: for unto those days the children of Israel did burn incense to it: and he called it Nehushtan.
- He removed the high places and broke the pillars and cut down the groves. And he broke in pieces the bronze serpent that Moses had made, for until those days the people of Israel had made offerings to it (it was called Nehushtan).
- 5

He trusted in the LORD God of Israel; so that after him was none like him among all the kings of Judah, nor any that were before him.
- He trusted in the LORD, the God of Israel, so that there was none like Him among all the kings of Judah after Him, nor among those who were before Him.

- 6 *For he clave to the LORD, and departed not from following him, but kept his commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses.* For He held fast to the LORD. He did not depart from following Him, but kept the commandments that the LORD commanded Moses.
- 7 *And the LORD was with him; and he prospered whithersoever he went forth: and he rebelled against the king of Assyria, and served him not.* The LORD was with Him; wherever He went out, He prospered. He rebelled against the king of Assyria and would not serve him.
- 8 *He smote the Philistines, even unto Gaza, and the borders thereof, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.* He struck down the Philistines as far as Gaza and its territory, from watchtower to fortified city.
- 9 *And it came to pass in the fourth year of king Hezekiah, which was the seventh year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, that Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against Samaria, and besieged it.* In the fourth year of King Hezekiah, which was the seventh year of Hoshea son of Elah, king of Israel, Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against Samaria and besieged it,
- 10 *And at the end of three years they took it: even in the sixth year of Hezekiah, that is the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel, Samaria was taken.* At the end of three years he took it. In the sixth year of Hezekiah, which was the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel, Samaria was taken.
- 11 *And the king of Assyria did carry away Israel unto Assyria, and put them in Halah and in Habor by the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes:* The king of Assyria carried the Israelites away to Assyria and put them in Halah, and on the Habor, the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes,
- 12 *Because they obeyed not the voice of the LORD their God, but transgressed his covenant, and all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded, and would not hear them, nor do them.* Because they did not obey the voice of the LORD their God but transgressed His covenant, even all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded. They neither listened nor obeyed.

- 13 *Now in the fourteenth year of king Hezekiah did Sennacherib king of Assyria come up against all the fenced cities of Judah, and took them.* In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the fortified cities of Judah and took them.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sennacherib** (seh-NAK-er-ib) — "*Sin (the moon-god) has replaced the brothers*" — King of Assyria (c. 705–681 BC) who invaded Judah and besieged Jerusalem. The angel of the LORD struck down 185,000 of his soldiers in a single night. He returned to Nineveh and was murdered by his own sons.

- 14 *And Hezekiah king of Judah sent to the king of Assyria to Lachish, saying, I have offended; return from me: that which thou putttest on me will I bear. And the king of Assyria appointed unto Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents of gold.* Hezekiah king of Judah sent to the king of Assyria at Lachish, saying, "I have done wrong; withdraw from me. Whatever you impose on me I will bear." And the king of Assyria required of Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents of gold.
- 15 *And Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house.* Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in the house of the LORD and in the treasuries of the king's house.
- 16 *At that time did Hezekiah cut off the gold from the doors of the temple of the LORD, and from the pillars which Hezekiah king of Judah had overlaid, and gave it to the king of Assyria.* At that time Hezekiah stripped the gold from the doors of the temple of the LORD and from the doorposts that Hezekiah king of Judah had overlaid and gave it to the king of Assyria.
- 17 *And the king of Assyria sent Tartan and Rabsaris and Rabshakeh from Lachish to king Hezekiah with a great host against Jerusalem. And they went up and came to Jerusalem. And when they were come up, they came and stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the highway of the fuller's field.* The king of Assyria sent the Tartan, the Rab-saris, and the Rabshakeh with a great army from Lachish to King Hezekiah at Jerusalem. And they went up and came to Jerusalem. When they arrived, they came and stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is on the highway to the Washer's Field.

- 18 *And when they had called to the king, there came out to them Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, which was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder.* When they called for the king, there came out to them Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, and Shebna the secretary, and Joah the son of Asaph, the recorder.
- 19 *And Rabshakeh said unto them, Speak ye now to Hezekiah, Thus saith the great king, the king of Assyria, What confidence is this wherein thou trustest?* The Rabshakeh said to them, "Say to Hezekiah, 'Thus says the great king, the king of Assyria: On what do you rest this trust of yours?"
- 20 *Thou sayest, (but they are but vain words,) I have counsel and strength for the war. Now on whom dost thou trust, that thou rebellest against me?* Do you think that mere words are strategy and power for war? In whom do you now trust, that you have rebelled against me?
- 21 *Now, behold, thou trustest upon the staff of this bruised reed, even upon Egypt, on which if a man lean, it will go into his hand, and pierce it: so is Pharaoh king of Egypt unto all that trust on him.* You are trusting now in Egypt, that broken reed of a staff, which will pierce the hand of any man who leans on it. Such is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust in him.
- 22 *But if ye say unto me, We trust in the LORD our God: is not that he, whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah hath taken away, and hath said to Judah and Jerusalem, Ye shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem?* But if You say to me, "We trust in the LORD our God," is it not He whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed, saying to Judah and to Jerusalem, "You shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem"?
- 23 *Now therefore, I pray thee, give pledges to my lord the king of Assyria, and I will deliver thee two thousand horses, if thou be able on thy part to set riders upon them.* Come now, make a wager with my master the king of Assyria: I will give you two thousand horses, if you are able on your part to set riders on them.

- 24 *How then wilt thou turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put thy trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?* How then can you repulse a single captain among the least of my master's servants, when you trust in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?
- 25 *Am I now come up without the LORD against this place to destroy it? The LORD said to me, Go up against this land, and destroy it.* Moreover, is it without the LORD that I have come up against this place to destroy it? The LORD said to me, Go up against this land, and destroy it.' "
- 26 *Then said Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, and Shebna, and Joah, unto Rabshakeh, Speak, I pray thee, to thy servants in the Syrian language; for we understand it: and talk not with us in the Jews' language in the ears of the people that are on the wall.* Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, and Shebna, and Joah said to the Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in the Syrian language, for we understand it. Do not speak to us in the Jews' language within the hearing of the people who are on the wall."
- 27 *But Rabshakeh said unto them, Hath my master sent me to thy master, and to thee, to speak these words? hath he not sent me to the men which sit on the wall, that they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you?* But the Rabshakeh said to them, "Has my master sent me to speak these words to Your master and to You, and not to the men sitting on the wall, who are doomed with You to eat their own dung and to drink their own urine?"
- 28 *Then Rabshakeh stood and cried with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and spake, saying, Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria:* Then the Rabshakeh stood and called out in a loud voice in the language of Judah: "Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria!
- 29 *Thus saith the king, Let not Hezekiah deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you out of his hand:* Thus says the king: 'Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he will not be able to deliver you out of my hand.
- 30 *Neither let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, The LORD will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.* Do not let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD by saying, "The LORD will surely deliver us, and this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria."

- 31 *Hearken not to Hezekiah: for thus saith the king of Assyria, Make an agreement with me by a present, and come out to me, and then eat ye every man of his own vine, and every one of his fig tree, and drink ye every one the waters of his cistern:* Do not listen to Hezekiah, for thus says the king of Assyria: "Make your peace with me and come out to me. Then each one of you will eat of his own vine, and each one of his own fig tree, and each one of you will drink the water of his own cistern,
- 32 *Until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of corn and wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of oil olive and of honey, that ye may live, and not die: and hearken not unto Hezekiah, when he persuadeth you, saying, The LORD will deliver us.* Until I come and take You away to a land like Your own land, a land of grain and wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive trees and honey, that You may live, and not die. And do not listen to Hezekiah when he misleads you by saying, 'The LORD will deliver us.'
- 33 *Hath any of the gods of the nations delivered at all his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?* Has any of the gods of the nations ever delivered his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?
- 34 *Where are the gods of Hamath, and of Arpad? where are the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivah? have they delivered Samaria out of mine hand?* Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah? Have they delivered Samaria out of my hand?
- 35 *Who are they among all the gods of the countries, that have delivered their country out of mine hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of mine hand?* Who among all the gods of the lands have delivered their lands out of my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?"
- 36 *But the people held their peace, and answered him not a word: for the king's commandment was, saying, Answer him not.* But the people were silent and answered him not a word, for the king's command was, "Do not answer him."

- 37 *Then came Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, which was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder, to Hezekiah with their clothes rent, and told him the words of Rabshakeh.* Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, and Shebna the secretary, and Joah the son of Asaph, the recorder, came to Hezekiah with their clothes torn and told him the words of the Rabshakeh.

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen-z*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Chr 28:27-29:1
- v3 — 2 Kgs 20:3
- v4 — 2 Chr 31:1; Num 21:8-9
- v5 — 2 Kgs 23:25; 2 Kgs 19:10; Matt 27:43; Eph 1:12
- v6 — Deut 10:20; Josh 23:8; John 14:15; Acts 11:23
- v7 — Ps 60:12; Gen 39:2-3; Rom 8:31; 2 Kgs 16:7; Matt 28:20
- v8 — Isa 14:29; 2 Kgs 17:9
- v15 — 1 Kgs 15:18-19; 2 Kgs 16:8
- v17 — Isa 20:1; 2 Kgs 20:20; Isa 7:3
- v21 — Isa 30:7
- v31 — 1 Kgs 4:25
- v32 — Deut 8:7-9

Chapter 19

Hezekiah prayed to the LORD and sent to the prophet Isaiah, who declared that God would defend Jerusalem. The angel of the LORD struck down 185,000 Assyrians in their camp, and Sennacherib returned to Nineveh where he was murdered by his own sons.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when king Hezekiah heard it, that he rent his clothes, and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the LORD.* As soon as King Hezekiah heard it, he tore his clothes and covered Himself with sackcloth and went into the house of the LORD.
- 2 *And he sent Eliakim, which was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.* He sent Eliakim, who was over the household, and Shebna the secretary, and the senior priests, covered with sackcloth, to the prophet Isaiah the son of Amoz.
- 3 *And they said unto him, Thus saith Hezekiah, This day is a day of trouble, and of rebuke, and blasphemy: for the children are come to the birth, and there is not strength to bring forth.* They said to him, "Thus says Hezekiah, 'This day is a day of distress, of rebuke, and of disgrace; children have come to the point of birth, and there is no strength to bring them forth.
- 4 *It may be the LORD thy God will hear all the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master hath sent to reproach the living God; and will reprove the words which the LORD thy God hath heard: wherefore lift up thy prayer for the remnant that are left.* It may be that the LORD Your God heard all the words of the Rabshakeh, whom his master the king of Assyria has sent to mock the living God, and will rebuke the words that the LORD Your God has heard; therefore lift up Your prayer for the remnant that is left.' "
- 5 *So the servants of king Hezekiah came to Isaiah.* When the servants of King Hezekiah came to Isaiah,
- 6 *And Isaiah said unto them, Thus shall ye say to your master, Thus saith the LORD, Be not afraid of the words which thou hast heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me.* Isaiah said to them, "Say to your master, 'Thus says the LORD: Do not be afraid because of the words that You have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have reviled me.

- 7 *Behold, I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and shall return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.* I will put a spirit in Him, so that He shall hear a rumor and return to His own land. I will make Him fall by the sword in His own land.' "
- 8 *So Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachish.* The Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria fighting against Libnah, for he had heard that the king had left Lachish.
- 9 *And when he heard say of Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, Behold, he is come out to fight against thee: he sent messengers again unto Hezekiah, saying,* Now the king heard concerning Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, "He has set out to fight against you." So he sent messengers again to Hezekiah, saying,
- 10 *Thus shall ye speak to Hezekiah king of Judah, saying, Let not thy God in whom thou trustest deceive thee, saying, Jerusalem shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.* "Thus shall you speak to Hezekiah king of Judah: 'Do not let your God in whom you trust deceive you by promising that Jerusalem will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.
- 11 *Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by destroying them utterly: and shalt thou be delivered?* You have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands, devoting them to destruction. And shall you be delivered?
- 12 *Have the gods of the nations delivered them which my fathers have destroyed; as Gozan, and Haran, and Rezeph, and the children of Eden which were in Thelassar?* Have the gods of the nations delivered them, the nations that my fathers destroyed, Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the people of Eden who were in Telassar?
- 13 *Where is the king of Hamath, and the king of Arpad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivah?* Where is the king of Hamath, the king of Arpad, the king of the city of Sepharvaim, the king of Hena, or the king of Ivvah?""

- 14 *And Hezekiah received the letter of the hand of the messengers, and read it: and Hezekiah went up into the house of the LORD, and spread it before the LORD.* Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers and read it. Hezekiah went up to the house of the LORD and spread it before the LORD.
- 15 *And Hezekiah prayed before the LORD, and said, O LORD God of Israel, which dwellest between the cherubims, thou art the God, even thou alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth; thou hast made heaven and earth.* Hezekiah prayed before the LORD and said: "O LORD, the God of Israel, enthroned above the cherubim, You are the God, You alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth; You have made heaven and earth.
- 16 *LORD, bow down thine ear, and hear: open, LORD, thine eyes, and see: and hear the words of Sennacherib, which hath sent him to reproach the living God.* Incline Your ear, O LORD, and hear; open Your eyes, O LORD, and see. Hear the words of Sennacherib, which he has sent to mock the living God.
- 17 *Of a truth, LORD, the kings of Assyria have destroyed the nations and their lands,* Truly, O LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste the nations and their lands
- 18 *And have cast their gods into the fire: for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone: therefore they have destroyed them.* Have cast their gods into the fire, for they were not gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone. Therefore they were destroyed.
- 19 *Now therefore, O LORD our God, I beseech thee, save thou us out of his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD God, even thou only.* So now, O LORD our God, please save us from His hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that You, O LORD, are God alone."
- 20 *Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, That which thou hast prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria I have heard.* Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: Your prayer to me about Sennacherib king of Assyria I have heard.

- 21 *This is the word that the LORD hath spoken concerning him; The virgin the daughter of Zion hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn; the daughter of Jerusalem hath shaken her head at thee.* This is the word that the LORD has spoken concerning Him: 'She despises You, she scorns You—the virgin daughter of Zion; she wags her head behind You—the daughter of Jerusalem.
- 22 *Whom hast thou reproached and blasphemed? and against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thine eyes on high? even against the Holy One of Israel.* Whom have You mocked and reviled? Against whom have You raised Your voice and lifted Your eyes to the heights? Against the Holy One of Israel!
- 23 *By thy messengers thou hast reproached the Lord, and hast said, With the multitude of my chariots I am come up to the height of the mountains, to the sides of Lebanon, and will cut down the tall cedar trees thereof, and the choice fir trees thereof: and I will enter into the lodgings of his borders, and into the forest of his Carmel.* By Your messengers You have mocked the Lord, and You have said, "With my many chariots I have gone up the heights of the mountains, to the far recesses of Lebanon, to cut down its tallest cedars, its choicest cypress trees, to come to its remotest height, its most fruitful forest.
- 24 *I have digged and drunk strange waters, and with the sole of my feet have I dried up all the rivers of besieged places.* I dug wells and drank foreign waters. I dried up with the sole of my foot all the streams of Egypt."
- 25 *Hast thou not heard long ago how I have done it, and of ancient times that I have formed it? now have I brought it to pass, that thou shouldest be to lay waste fenced cities into ruinous heaps.* Have You not heard that I determined it long ago? I planned from days of old what now I bring to pass, that You should make fortified cities crash into heaps of ruins,

- 26 *Therefore their inhabitants were of small power, they were dismayed and confounded; they were as the grass of the field, and as the green herb, as the grass on the housetops, and as corn blasted before it be grown up.* While their inhabitants, shorn of strength, are dismayed and confounded, and have become like plants of the field and like tender grass, like grass on the housetops, blighted before it is grown.
- 27 *But I know thy abode, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy rage against me.* I know Your sitting down and Your going out and coming in, and Your raging against me.
- 28 *Because thy rage against me and thy tumult is come up into mine ears, therefore I will put my hook in thy nose, and my bridle in thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest.* Because You have raged against me and Your complacency has come into my ears, I will put my hook in Your nose and my bit in Your mouth. I will turn You back on the way by which You came.
- 29 *And this shall be a sign unto thee, Ye shall eat this year such things as grow of themselves, and in the second year that which springeth of the same; and in the third year sow ye, and reap, and plant vineyards, and eat the fruits thereof.* This shall be the sign for You: this year You shall eat what grows of itself, and in the second year what springs from that. Then in the third year sow and reap and plant vineyards, and eat their fruit.
- 30 *And the remnant that is escaped of the house of Judah shall yet again take root downward, and bear fruit upward.* The surviving remnant of the house of Judah shall again take root downward and bear fruit upward.
- 31 *For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and they that escape out of mount Zion: the zeal of the LORD of hosts shall do this.* For out of Jerusalem shall go a remnant, and out of Mount Zion a band of survivors. The zeal of the LORD will do this.

- 32 *Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a bank against it.* Therefore thus says the LORD concerning the king of Assyria: He shall not come into this city or shoot an arrow there, or come before it with a shield or cast up a siege mound against it.
- 33 *By the way that he came, by the same shall he return, and shall not come into this city, saith the LORD.* By the way that He came, by the same He shall return. He shall not come into this city, declares the LORD.
- 34 *For I will defend this city, to save it, for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.* For I will defend this city to save it, for my own sake and for the sake of my servant David."
- 35 *And it came to pass that night, that the angel of the LORD went out, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians an hundred fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.* That night the angel of the LORD went out and struck down 185,000 in the camp of the Assyrians. And when people arose early in the morning, these were all dead bodies.
- 36 *So Sennacherib king of Assyria departed, and went and returned, and dwelt at Nineveh.* Then Sennacherib king of Assyria departed and went home and lived at Nineveh.
- 37 *And it came to pass, as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, that Adrammelech and Sharezer his sons smote him with the sword: and they escaped into the land of Armenia. And Esarhaddon his son reigned in his stead.* As He was worshipping in the house of Nisroch His god, Adrammelech and Sharezer, His sons, struck Him down with the sword and escaped into the land of Armenia. And Esarhaddon His son reigned in His place.

Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his

name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Nineveh (*NIN-eh-veh*) — The capital of Assyria — the great city to which Jonah was sent; when he preached, the whole city repented; it was later destroyed as Nahum prophesied.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 21:27; 2 Kgs 18:37

v4 — 2 Sam 16:12

v6 — Isa 37:6-38; 2 Kgs 18:17; 2 Kgs 18:35

v16 — Ps 31:2; 2 Chr 6:40; Isa 37:17; 2 Kgs 19:4

v20 — 2 Kgs 20:5; 2 Chr 32:20-21; Isa 65:24; 1 John 5:14-15; Acts 10:31

v21 — Lam 2:13

v28 — Ezek 29:4; Ezek 38:4; 2 Kgs 19:33

v29 — Lev 25:20-22; 2 Kgs 20:8-9; Ex 3:12

v30 — 2 Kgs 19:4; Isa 27:6

v31 — Isa 9:7

v34 — 1 Kgs 11:12-13; 2 Kgs 20:6; 1 Kgs 15:4; Isa 31:5; Jer 33:26

v35 — 2 Chr 32:21-22; 2 Sam 24:16; Ex 12:29-30; Isa 37:36; Ps 76:5-7

Chapter 20

Hezekiah fell deathly ill, but after praying, the LORD added fifteen years to his life, confirmed by the sign of the shadow retreating ten steps. Hezekiah foolishly showed all his treasures to Babylonian envoys, and Isaiah prophesied that everything would be carried to Babylon.

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| <p>¹ <i>In those days was Hezekiah sick unto death. And the prophet Isaiah the son of Amoz came to him, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order; for thou shalt die, and not live.</i></p> | <p>In those days Hezekiah became sick and was at the point of death. And Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came to him and said to Him, "Thus says the LORD, 'Set Your house in order, for You shall die; You shall not recover.' "</p> |
| <p>² <i>Then he turned his face to the wall, and prayed unto the LORD, saying,</i></p> | <p>Then Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD, saying,</p> |

- 3 *I beseech thee, O LORD, remember now how I have walked before thee in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in thy sight. And Hezekiah wept sore.* "Please, O LORD, remember how I have walked before You in faithfulness and with a whole heart, and have done what is good in Your sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly.
- 4 *And it came to pass, afore Isaiah was gone out into the middle court, that the word of the LORD came to him, saying,* Before Isaiah had gone out of the middle court, the word of the LORD came to Him:
- 5 *Turn again, and tell Hezekiah the captain of my people, Thus saith the LORD, the God of David thy father, I have heard thy prayer, I have seen thy tears: behold, I will heal thee: on the third day thou shalt go up unto the house of the LORD.* "Turn back, and say to Hezekiah the leader of my people, Thus says the LORD, the God of David your father: I have heard your prayer; I have seen Your tears. I will heal You. On the third day You shall go up to the house of the LORD,
- 6 *And I will add unto thy days fifteen years; and I will deliver thee and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria; and I will defend this city for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.* I will add fifteen years to your life. I will deliver you and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend this city for my own sake and for my servant David's sake."
- 7 *And Isaiah said, Take a lump of figs. And they took and laid it on the boil, and he recovered.* Isaiah said, "Bring a cake of figs." And let them take and lay it on the boil, that he may recover."
- 8 *And Hezekiah said unto Isaiah, What shall be the sign that the LORD will heal me, and that I shall go up into the house of the LORD the third day?* Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "What shall be the sign that the LORD will heal me, and that I shall go up to the house of the LORD on the third day?"
- 9 *And Isaiah said, This sign shalt thou have of the LORD, that the LORD will do the thing that he hath spoken: shall the shadow go forward ten degrees, or go back ten degrees?* Isaiah said, "This shall be the sign to you from the LORD, that the LORD will do the thing that He has promised: shall the shadow go forward ten steps, or go back ten steps?"

- 10 *And Hezekiah answered, It is a light thing for the shadow to go down ten degrees: nay, but let the shadow return backward ten degrees.* Hezekiah answered, "It is an easy thing for the shadow to lengthen ten steps. Rather let the shadow go back ten steps."
- 11 *And Isaiah the prophet cried unto the LORD: and he brought the shadow ten degrees backward, by which it had gone down in the dial of Ahaz.* Isaiah the prophet cried to the LORD. He brought the shadow back ten steps, by which it had gone down on the sundial of Ahaz.
- 12 *At that time Berodachbaladan, the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present unto Hezekiah: for he had heard that Hezekiah had been sick.* At that time Merodach-baladan the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent envoys with letters and a present to Hezekiah, for he heard that Hezekiah had been sick.
- 13 *And Hezekiah hearkened unto them, and shewed them all the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.* Hezekiah welcomed them. He showed them all his treasure house, the silver, the gold, the spices, the precious oil, his armory, all that was found in his storehouses. There was nothing in his house or in all his realm that Hezekiah did not show them.
- 14 *Then came Isaiah the prophet unto king Hezekiah, and said unto him, What said these men? and from whence came they unto thee? And Hezekiah said, They are come from a far country, even from Babylon.* Then Isaiah the prophet came to King Hezekiah, and said to him, "What did these men say? And from where did they come to you?" And Hezekiah said, "They have come from a far country, from Babylon."
- 15 *And he said, What have they seen in thine house? And Hezekiah answered, All the things that are in mine house have they seen: there is nothing among my treasures that I have not shewed them.* He said, "What have they seen in your house?" And Hezekiah answered, "They have seen all that is in my house; there is nothing in my storehouses that I did not show them."

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| <p>16 <i>And Isaiah said unto Hezekiah, Hear the word of the LORD.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Behold, the days come, that all that is in thine house, and that which thy fathers have laid up in store unto this day, shall be carried into Babylon: nothing shall be left, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And of thy sons that shall issue from thee, which thou shalt beget, shall they take away; and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Then said Hezekiah unto Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken. And he said, Is it not good, if peace and truth be in my days?</i></p> <p>20 <i>And the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and all his might, and how he made a pool, and a conduit, and brought water into the city, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Hezekiah slept with his fathers: and Manasseh his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the word of the LORD:</p> <p>The days are coming, when all that is in Your house, and that which Your fathers have stored up till this day, shall be carried to Babylon. Nothing shall be left, says the LORD.</p> <p>Some of your own sons, who will come from you, whom you will father, shall be taken away. They shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon."</p> <p>Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "The word of the LORD that you have spoken is good." For he thought, "Why not, if there will be peace and security in my days?"</p> <p>The rest of the deeds of Hezekiah and all his might and how he made the pool and the conduit and brought water into the city, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> <p>Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and Manasseh his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Isaiah (eye-ZAY-ah) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 38:1-22; 2 Chr 32:24-26; Phil 2:27; Jonah 3:4-10; 2 Kgs 19:20
v2 — Ps 50:15
v3 — Neh 13:14; Neh 13:22; 2 Kgs 18:3-6; Neh 5:19; 1 John 3:21-22

v5 — Ps 66:19-20; Isa 38:5; 1 Sam 9:16; 2 Kgs 19:20; Ps 39:12

v6 — 2 Kgs 19:34

v7 — Isa 38:21

v17 — 2 Kgs 24:13; 2 Chr 36:10

v18 — 2 Chr 33:11

v20 — Neh 3:16

Manasseh of Judah — 686–642 BC
Amon of Judah — 642–640 BC

Chapter 21

Manasseh reigned fifty-five years and did great evil, rebuilding high places, worshiping Baal, and shedding innocent blood until Jerusalem was filled with it. His son Amon reigned two years and was assassinated by his servants.

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| 1 | <i>Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and reigned fifty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hephzibah.</i> | Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign. He reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hephzibah. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, after the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to the despicable practices of the nations whom the LORD drove out before the people of Israel. |
| 3 | <i>For he built up again the high places which Hezekiah his father had destroyed; and he reared up altars for Baal, and made a grove, as did Ahab king of Israel; and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served them.</i> | For he rebuilt the high places that Hezekiah his father had destroyed. He erected altars for Baal and made a grove, as Ahab king of Israel had done, and worshiped all the host of heaven and served them. |
| 4 | <i>And he built altars in the house of the LORD, of which the LORD said, In Jerusalem will I put my name.</i> | He built altars in the house of the LORD, of which the LORD had said, "In Jerusalem will I put my name." |
| 5 | <i>And he built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD.</i> | He built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD. |

- 6 *And he made his son pass through the fire, and observed times, and used enchantments, and dealt with familiar spirits and wizards: he wrought much wickedness in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.* He made His son pass through the fire and used fortune-telling and omens and dealt with familiar spirits and wizards. He did much evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger.
- 7 *And he set a graven image of the grove that he had made in the house, of which the LORD said to David, and to Solomon his son, In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all tribes of Israel, will I put my name for ever:* The graven image of the grove that He had made He set in the house of which the LORD said to David and to Solomon his son, "In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever.
- 8 *Neither will I make the feet of Israel move any more out of the land which I gave their fathers; only if they will observe to do according to all that I have commanded them, and according to all the law that my servant Moses commanded them.* I will not cause the feet of Israel to wander anymore out of the land that I gave to their fathers, if only they will be careful to do according to all that I have commanded them, and according to all the Law that my servant Moses commanded them."
- 9 *But they hearkened not: and Manasseh seduced them to do more evil than did the nations whom the LORD destroyed before the children of Israel.* But they did not listen, and Manasseh led them astray to do more evil than the nations had done whom the LORD destroyed before the people of Israel.
- 10 *And the LORD spake by his servants the prophets, saying,* The LORD said by His servants the prophets,
- 11 *Because Manasseh king of Judah hath done these abominations, and hath done wickedly above all that the Amorites did, which were before him, and hath made Judah also to sin with his idols:* "Because Manasseh king of Judah has committed these abominations and has done things more evil than all that the Amorites did, who were before him, and has made Judah also to sin with his idols,

- 12 *Therefore thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Behold, I am bringing such evil upon Jerusalem and Judah, that whosoever heareth of it, both his ears shall tingle.* Therefore thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: I am bringing upon Jerusalem and Judah such disaster that the ears of everyone who hears of it will tingle.
- 13 *And I will stretch over Jerusalem the line of Samaria, and the plummet of the house of Ahab: and I will wipe Jerusalem as a man wipeth a dish, wiping it, and turning it upside down.* I will stretch over Jerusalem the measuring line of Samaria, and the plumb line of the house of Ahab. I will wipe Jerusalem as one wipes a dish, wiping it and turning it upside down.
- 14 *And I will forsake the remnant of mine inheritance, and deliver them into the hand of their enemies; and they shall become a prey and a spoil to all their enemies;* I will forsake the remnant of my heritage and give them into the hand of their enemies. They shall become a prey and a spoil to all their enemies,
- 15 *Because they have done that which was evil in my sight, and have provoked me to anger, since the day their fathers came forth out of Egypt, even unto this day.* Because they have done what is evil in my sight and have provoked me to anger, since the day their fathers came out of Egypt, even to this day."
- 16 *Moreover Manasseh shed innocent blood very much, till he had filled Jerusalem from one end to another; beside his sin wherewith he made Judah to sin, in doing that which was evil in the sight of the LORD.* Moreover, Manasseh shed very much innocent blood, till he had filled Jerusalem from one end to another, besides the sin that He made Judah to sin so that they did what was evil in the sight of the LORD.
- 17 *Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and all that he did, and his sin that he sinned, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh and all that he did, and the sin that he committed, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 18 *And Manasseh slept with his fathers, and was buried in the garden of his own house, in the garden of Uzza: and Amon his son reigned in his stead.* Manasseh slept with his fathers and was buried in the garden of his house, in the garden of Uzza, and Amon his son reigned in his place.

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| <p>19 <i>Amon was twenty and two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Meshullemeth, the daughter of Haruz of Jotbah.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as his father Manasseh did.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And he walked in all the way that his father walked in, and served the idols that his father served, and worshipped them:</i></p> <p>22 <i>And he forsook the LORD God of his fathers, and walked not in the way of the LORD.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And the servants of Amon conspired against him, and slew the king in his own house.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And the people of the land slew all them that had conspired against king Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his stead.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Amon which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</i></p> <p>26 <i>And he was buried in his sepulchre in the garden of Uzza: and Josiah his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>Amon was twenty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Meshullemeth the daughter of Haruz of Jotbah.</p> <p>He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, as Manasseh his father had done.</p> <p>He walked in all the way in which His father walked and served the idols that His father served and worshiped them.</p> <p>He abandoned the LORD, the God of His fathers, and did not walk in the way of the LORD.</p> <p>The servants of Amon conspired against him and put the king to death in his own house.</p> <p>But the people of the land struck down all those who had conspired against King Amon, and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his place.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Amon that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> <p>He was buried in his tomb in the garden of Uzza, and Josiah his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

- Amorites** (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'
- Josiah** (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'
- Solomon** (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Kgs 17:16; 2 Kgs 18:4
- v4 — 1 Kgs 8:29; 2 Sam 7:13
- v5 — 1 Kgs 7:12
- v6 — 2 Kgs 17:17; Lev 19:31; Lev 18:21
- v7 — 2 Chr 7:16
- v9 — Prov 29:12
- v11 — 1 Kgs 21:26; 2 Kgs 24:3-4
- v12 — Jer 19:3
- v13 — Amos 7:7-8; Lam 2:8; Isa 34:11

Josiah of Judah — 640–609 BC

Chapter 22

Josiah ordered the repair of the temple, and Hilkiah the priest found the Book of the Law. When it was read to Josiah, he tore his clothes; the prophetess Huldah confirmed that God's wrath was determined against Judah but would be delayed because of Josiah's repentance.

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| 1 | <i>Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty and one years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jedidah, the daughter of Adaiah of Boscath.</i> | <i>Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign. He reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jedidah the daughter of Adaiah of Bozkath.</i> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Josiah** (*joh-SY-ah*) — "the LORD heals" — Judah's last great reforming king, who began to reign at age eight. When the Book of the Law was found in the temple during repairs, he tore his clothes, purged the land of idolatry, and renewed the covenant. He was killed at the battle of Megiddo at age thirty-nine.

- 2 *And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, and walked in all the way of David his father, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left.* He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD and walked in all the way of David his father. He did not turn aside to the right or to the left.
- 3 *And it came to pass in the eighteenth year of king Josiah, that the king sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, the son of Meshullam, the scribe, to the house of the LORD, saying,* In the eighteenth year of King Josiah, the king sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, son of Meshullam, the secretary, to the house of the LORD, saying,
- 4 *Go up to Hilkiyah the high priest, that he may sum the silver which is brought into the house of the LORD, which the keepers of the door have gathered of the people:* "Go up to Hilkiyah the high priest, that He may count the money that has been brought into the house of the LORD, which the keepers of the threshold have collected from the people.
- 5 *And let them deliver it into the hand of the doers of the work, that have the oversight of the house of the LORD: and let them give it to the doers of the work which is in the house of the LORD, to repair the breaches of the house,* Let it be given into the hand of the workmen who have the oversight of the house of the LORD, and let them give it to the workmen who are at the house of the LORD, repairing the house
- 6 *Unto carpenters, and builders, and masons, and to buy timber and hewn stone to repair the house.* (that is, to the carpenters, and to the builders, and to the masons), and let them use it to buy timber and quarried stone to repair the house.
- 7 *Howbeit there was no reckoning made with them of the money that was delivered into their hand, because they dealt faithfully.* But no accounting shall be asked from them for the money that is delivered into their hand, for they deal honestly."
- 8 *And Hilkiyah the high priest said unto Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiyah gave the book to Shaphan, and he read it.* Hilkiyah the high priest said to Shaphan the secretary, "I have found the Book of the Law in the house of the LORD." And Hilkiyah gave the book to Shaphan. He read it.

- 9 *And Shaphan the scribe came to the king, and brought the king word again, and said, Thy servants have gathered the money that was found in the house, and have delivered it into the hand of them that do the work, that have the oversight of the house of the LORD.* Shaphan the secretary came to the king and reported to the king, "Your servants have emptied out the money that was found in the house and have delivered it into the hand of the workmen who have the oversight of the house of the LORD."
- 10 *And Shaphan the scribe shewed the king, saying, Hilkiyah the priest hath delivered me a book. And Shaphan read it before the king.* Then Shaphan the secretary told the king, "Hilkiyah the priest has given me a book." And Shaphan read it before the king.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes.* When the king heard the words of the Book of the Law, he tore his clothes.
- 12 *And the king commanded Hilkiyah the priest, and Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Achbor the son of Michaiah, and Shaphan the scribe, and Asahiah a servant of the king's, saying,* The king commanded Hilkiyah the priest, and Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Achbor the son of Michaiah, and Shaphan the secretary, and Asaiah the king's servant, saying,
- 13 *Go ye, enquire of the LORD for me, and for the people, and for all Judah, concerning the words of this book that is found: for great is the wrath of the LORD that is kindled against us, because our fathers have not hearkened unto the words of this book, to do according unto all that which is written concerning us.* "Go, inquire of the LORD for me, and for the people, and for all Judah, concerning the words of this book that has been found. For great is the wrath of the LORD that is kindled against us, because our fathers have not obeyed the words of this book, to do according to all that is written concerning us."

- 14 *So Hilkiah the priest, and Ahikam, and Achbor, and Shaphan, and Asahiah, went unto Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvah, the son of Harhas, keeper of the wardrobe; (now she dwelt in Jerusalem in the college;) and they communed with her.* So Hilkiah the priest, and Ahikam, and Achbor, and Shaphan, and Asahiah went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvah, son of Harhas, keeper of the wardrobe (now she lived in Jerusalem in the Second Quarter). They talked with her.
- 15 *And she said unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Tell the man that sent you to me,* She said to them, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: 'Tell the man who sent you to me,
- 16 *Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, even all the words of the book which the king of Judah hath read:* Thus says the LORD, I will bring disaster upon this place and upon its inhabitants, all the words of the book that the king of Judah has read.
- 17 *Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be kindled against this place, and shall not be quenched.* Because they have abandoned me and have made offerings to other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the work of their hands, therefore my wrath will be kindled against this place. It will not be quenched.
- 18 *But to the king of Judah which sent you to enquire of the LORD, thus shall ye say to him, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, As touching the words which thou hast heard;* But to the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of the LORD, thus shall You say to Him, Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: Regarding the words that You have heard,

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Because thine heart was tender, and thou hast humbled thyself before the LORD, when thou heardest what I spake against this place, and against the inhabitants thereof, that they should become a desolation and a curse, and hast rent thy clothes, and wept before me; I also have heard thee, saith the LORD.
- Because Your heart was penitent, and You humbled Yourself before the LORD, when You heard how I spoke against this place and against its inhabitants that they would become a desolation and a curse, and You have torn Your clothes and wept before me, I also have heard You, declares the LORD.
- 20

Behold therefore, I will gather thee unto thy fathers, and thou shalt be gathered into thy grave in peace; and thine eyes shall not see all the evil which I will bring upon this place. And they brought the king word again.
- Therefore, I will gather you to your fathers, and you shall be gathered to your grave in peace, and your eyes shall not see all the disaster that I will bring upon this place.' " And they brought back word to the king.

Words in this chapter:

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Josh 15:39; 2 Chr 34:1-33
- v2 — Deut 5:32; Josh 1:7; 2 Kgs 18:3; 1 Kgs 3:6
- v4 — 2 Kgs 12:4
- v7 — 2 Kgs 12:15
- v8 — Deut 31:24-26; 2 Chr 34:14-28
- v11 — 2 Chr 34:19; Joel 2:13
- v12 — Jer 26:24
- v19 — Ps 51:17; 1 Kgs 21:29; Isa 57:15; Ex 10:3; Mic 6:8
- v20 — Ps 37:37; Isa 57:1-2; 1 Chr 17:11

<i>Jehoahaz of Judah — 609 BC (three months)</i>
<i>Jehoiakim of Judah — 609–598 BC</i>

Chapter 23

Josiah read the Book of the Law before all the people, renewed the covenant, and destroyed the high places, altars, Asherah poles, and mediums throughout Judah. He celebrated a great

Passover but was killed in battle against Pharaoh Neco at Megiddo.

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| 1 | <i>And the king sent, and they gathered unto him all the elders of Judah and of Jerusalem.</i> | Then the king sent. All the elders of Judah and Jerusalem were gathered to him. |
| 2 | <i>And the king went up into the house of the LORD, and all the men of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, and the priests, and the prophets, and all the people, both small and great: and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant which was found in the house of the LORD.</i> | The king went up to the house of the LORD, and with Him all the men of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem and the priests and the prophets, all the people, both small and great. And he read in their hearing all the words of the Book of the Covenant that had been found in the house of the LORD. |
| 3 | <i>And the king stood by a pillar, and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments and his testimonies and his statutes with all their heart and all their soul, to perform the words of this covenant that were written in this book. And all the people stood to the covenant.</i> | The king stood by the pillar and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD and to keep His commandments and His testimonies and His statutes with all His heart and all His soul, to perform the words of this covenant that were written in this book. And all the people joined in the covenant. |
| 4 | <i>And the king commanded Hilkiah the high priest, and the priests of the second order, and the keepers of the door, to bring forth out of the temple of the LORD all the vessels that were made for Baal, and for the grove, and for all the host of heaven: and he burned them without Jerusalem in the fields of Kidron, and carried the ashes of them unto Bethel.</i> | The king commanded Hilkiah the high priest and the priests of the second order and the keepers of the threshold to bring out of the temple of the LORD all the vessels made for Baal, for the grove, and for all the host of heaven. He burned them outside Jerusalem in the fields of the Kidron and carried their ashes to Bethel. |

- 5 *And he put down the idolatrous priests, whom the kings of Judah had ordained to burn incense in the high places in the cities of Judah, and in the places round about Jerusalem; them also that burned incense unto Baal, to the sun, and to the moon, and to the planets, and to all the host of heaven.* He deposed the priests whom the kings of Judah had ordained to make offerings in the high places at the cities of Judah and around Jerusalem; those also who burned incense to Baal, to the sun and the moon and the constellations and all the host of the heavens.
- 6 *And he brought out the grove from the house of the LORD, without Jerusalem, unto the brook Kidron, and burned it at the brook Kidron, and stamped it small to powder, and cast the powder thereof upon the graves of the children of the people.* He brought out the grove from the house of the LORD, outside Jerusalem, to the brook Kidron, and burned it at the brook Kidron and beat it to dust and cast the dust of it upon the graves of the common people.
- 7 *And he brake down the houses of the sodomites, that were by the house of the LORD, where the women wove hangings for the grove.* He tore down the houses of the sodomites who were in the house of the LORD, where the women wove hangings for the grove.
- 8 *And he brought all the priests out of the cities of Judah, and defiled the high places where the priests had burned incense, from Geba to Beersheba, and brake down the high places of the gates that were in the entering in of the gate of Joshua the governor of the city, which were on a man's left hand at the gate of the city.* He brought all the priests out of the cities of Judah, and defiled the high places where the priests had made offerings, from Geba to Beersheba. And he broke down the high places of the gates that were at the entrance of the gate of Joshua the governor of the city, which were on one's left at the gate of the city.
- 9 *Nevertheless the priests of the high places came not up to the altar of the LORD in Jerusalem, but they did eat of the unleavened bread among their brethren.* However, the priests of the high places did not come up to the altar of the LORD in Jerusalem. But they ate unleavened bread among their brothers.

- 10 *And he defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the children of Hinnom, that no man might make his son or his daughter to pass through the fire to Molech.* He defiled Topheth, which is in the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, that no one might burn his son or his daughter as an offering to Molech.
- 11 *And he took away the horses that the kings of Judah had given to the sun, at the entering in of the house of the LORD, by the chamber of Nathanmelech the chamberlain, which was in the suburbs, and burned the chariots of the sun with fire.* He removed the horses that the kings of Judah had dedicated to the sun, at the entrance to the house of the LORD, by the chamber of Nathan-melech the chamberlain, which was in the precincts. And He burned the chariots of the sun with fire.
- 12 *And the altars that were on the top of the upper chamber of Ahaz, which the kings of Judah had made, and the altars which Manasseh had made in the two courts of the house of the LORD, did the king beat down, and brake them down from thence, and cast the dust of them into the brook Kidron.* The altars on the roof of the upper chamber of Ahaz, which the kings of Judah had made, and the altars that Manasseh had made in the two courts of the house of the LORD, the king broke down and ran from there and cast the dust of them into the brook Kidron.
- 13 *And the high places that were before Jerusalem, which were on the right hand of the mount of corruption, which Solomon the king of Israel had builded for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Zidonians, and for Chemosh the abomination of the Moabites, and for Milcom the abomination of the children of Ammon, did the king defile.* The king defiled the high places that were east of Jerusalem, to the south of the mount of corruption, which Solomon the king of Israel had built for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Zidonians, and for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, and for Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.
- 14 *And he brake in pieces the images, and cut down the groves, and filled their places with the bones of men.* He broke in pieces the images and cut down the groves and filled their places with the bones of men.

- 15 *Moreover the altar that was at Bethel, and the high place which Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, had made, both that altar and the high place he brake down, and burned the high place, and stamped it small to powder, and burned the grove.* Moreover, the altar at Bethel, the high place erected by Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, that altar with the high place he pulled down and burned, reducing it to dust. He also burned the grove.
- 16 *And as Josiah turned himself, he spied the sepulchres that were there in the mount, and sent, and took the bones out of the sepulchres, and burned them upon the altar, and polluted it, according to the word of the LORD which the man of God proclaimed, who proclaimed these words.* As Josiah turned, he saw the tombs there on the mount. And He sent and took the bones out of the tombs and burned them on the altar and defiled it, according to the word of the LORD that the man of God proclaimed, who had predicted these things.
- 17 *Then he said, What title is that that I see? And the men of the city told him, It is the sepulchre of the man of God, which came from Judah, and proclaimed these things that thou hast done against the altar of Bethel.* Then he said, "What is that monument that I see?" And the men of the city told him, "It is the tomb of the man of God Who came from Judah and predicted these things that you have done against the altar at Bethel."
- 18 *And he said, Let him alone; let no man move his bones. So they let his bones alone, with the bones of the prophet that came out of Samaria.* He said, "Let him be; let no man move his bones." So they let his bones alone, with the bones of the prophet who came out of Samaria.
- 19 *And all the houses also of the high places that were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke the LORD to anger, Josiah took away, and did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Bethel.* Josiah removed all the shrines also of the high places that were in the cities of Samaria, which kings of Israel had made, provoking the LORD to anger. He did to them according to all that He had done at Bethel.

- 20 *And he slew all the priests of the high places that were there upon the altars, and burned men's bones upon them, and returned to Jerusalem.* He sacrificed all the priests of the high places who were there on the altars, and burned human bones on them. Then He returned to Jerusalem.
- 21 *And the king commanded all the people, saying, Keep the passover unto the LORD your God, as it is written in the book of this covenant.* The king commanded all the people, "Keep the Passover to the LORD Your God, as it is written in this Book of the Covenant."
- 22 *Surely there was not holden such a passover from the days of the judges that judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, nor of the kings of Judah;* For no such Passover had been kept since the days of the judges who judged Israel, or during all the days of the kings of Israel or of the kings of Judah.
- 23 *But in the eighteenth year of king Josiah, wherein this passover was holden to the LORD in Jerusalem.* But in the eighteenth year of King Josiah this Passover was kept to the LORD in Jerusalem.
- 24 *Moreover the workers with familiar spirits, and the wizards, and the images, and the idols, and all the abominations that were spied in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, did Josiah put away, that he might perform the words of the law which were written in the book that Hilkiah the priest found in the house of the LORD.* Moreover, Josiah put away those that had familiar spirits, and the wizards, and the images and the idols and all the abominations that were seen in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, that He might establish the words of the law that were written in the book that Hilkiah the priest found in the house of the LORD.
- 25 *And like unto him was there no king before him, that turned to the LORD with all his heart, and with all his soul, and with all his might, according to all the law of Moses; neither after him arose there any like him.* Before Him there was no king like Him, who turned to the LORD with all His heart and with all His soul and with all His might, according to all the Law of Moses, nor did any like him arise after him.

- 26 *Notwithstanding the LORD turned not from the fierceness of his great wrath, wherewith his anger was kindled against Judah, because of all the provocations that Manasseh had provoked him withal.* Still the LORD did not turn from the burning of His great wrath, by which His anger was kindled against Judah, because of all the provocations with which Manasseh had provoked him.
- 27 *And the LORD said, I will remove Judah also out of my sight, as I have removed Israel, and will cast off this city Jerusalem which I have chosen, and the house of which I said, My name shall be there.* The LORD said, "I will remove Judah also out of my sight, as I have removed Israel. I will cast off this city that I have chosen, Jerusalem, and the house of which I said, My name shall be there."
- 28 *Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?* Now the rest of the acts of Josiah and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?
- 29 *In his days Pharaohnechoh king of Egypt went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates: and king Josiah went against him; and he slew him at Megiddo, when he had seen him.* In his days Pharaoh Neco king of Egypt went up to the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates. King Josiah went to meet him, and Pharaoh Neco killed him at Megiddo, as soon as he saw him.
- 30 *And his servants carried him in a chariot dead from Megiddo, and brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own sepulchre. And the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and anointed him, and made him king in his father's stead.* His servants carried him dead in a chariot from Megiddo and brought him to Jerusalem and buried him in his own tomb. And the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and anointed him, and made him king in his father's place.
- 31 *Jehoahaz was twenty and three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.* Jehoahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign. He reigned three months in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.

- 32 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his fathers had done.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that His fathers had done.
- 33 *And Pharaohnechoh put him in bands at Riblah in the land of Hamath, that he might not reign in Jerusalem; and put the land to a tribute of an hundred talents of silver, and a talent of gold.* Pharaoh Neco put him in bonds at Riblah in the land of Hamath, that he might not reign in Jerusalem, and laid on the land a tribute of a hundred talents of silver and a talent of gold.
- 34 *And Pharaohnechoh made Eliakim the son of Josiah king in the room of Josiah his father, and turned his name to Jehoiakim, and took Jehoahaz away: and he came to Egypt, and died there.* Pharaoh Neco made Eliakim the son of Josiah king in the place of Josiah his father, and changed his name to Jehoiakim. But he took Jehoahaz away. He came to Egypt and died there.
- 35 *And Jehoiakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; but he taxed the land to give the money according to the commandment of Pharaoh: he exacted the silver and the gold of the people of the land, of every one according to his taxation, to give it unto Pharaohnechoh.* Jehoiakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh. But he taxed the land to give the money according to the command of Pharaoh. He exacted the silver and the gold of the people of the land, from everyone according to his assessment, to give it to Pharaoh Neco.
- 36 *Jehoiakim was twenty and five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Zebudah, the daughter of Pedaiah of Rumah.* Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zebidah the daughter of Pedaiah of Rumah.
- 37 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his fathers had done.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that His fathers had done.

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Kgs 11:14; 2 Kgs 11:17
- v7 — Ezek 16:16; 1 Kgs 15:12; 1 Kgs 14:24
- v10 — Jer 19:6; Isa 30:33; Lev 18:21; Jer 7:31-32
- v12 — Jer 19:13; 2 Kgs 21:5; Zeph 1:5
- v13 — 1 Kgs 11:5; 1 Kgs 11:7
- v16 — 1 Kgs 13:1-2; 1 Kgs 13:32
- v17 — 1 Kgs 13:1; 1 Kgs 13:30-31
- v25 — 2 Kgs 18:5; Jer 29:13
- v27 — 2 Kgs 18:11; 2 Kgs 21:13
- v29 — Jer 46:2; 2 Chr 35:20-24
- v31 — Jer 22:11; 2 Kgs 24:18; 1 Chr 3:15
- v33 — 2 Kgs 25:6; 1 Kgs 8:65

Jehoiachin of Judah — 598–597 BC (three months)
Zedekiah of Judah — 597–586 BC (last king of Judah)

Chapter 24

Jehoiakim served Nebuchadnezzar three years and then rebelled, bringing Babylon's wrath upon Judah. Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem, carried away King Jehoiachin, the temple treasures, and 10,000 captives to Babylon, and made Zedekiah king.

1	<i>In his days Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up, and Jehoiakim became his servant three years: then he turned and rebelled against him.</i>	In his days Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up, and Jehoiakim became his servant for three years. Then he turned and rebelled against him.
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nebuchadnezzar** (neb-yoo-kad-NEZ-er) — "Nabu, protect my firstborn son" — King of Babylon (c. 605–562 BC) who destroyed Jerusalem and the temple in 586 BC and carried Judah into exile. God used him as His instrument of judgment but later humbled him personally (Daniel 4).

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| <p>2 And the LORD sent against him bands of the Chaldees, and bands of the Syrians, and bands of the Moabites, and bands of the children of Ammon, and sent them against Judah to destroy it, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by his servants the prophets.</p> | <p>The LORD sent against Him bands of the Chaldeans and bands of the Syrians and bands of the Moabites and bands of the Ammonites, and sent them against Judah to destroy it, according to the word of the LORD that He spoke by His servants the prophets.</p> |
| <p>3 Surely at the commandment of the LORD came this upon Judah, to remove them out of his sight, for the sins of Manasseh, according to all that he did;</p> | <p>Surely this came upon Judah at the command of the LORD, to remove them out of His sight, for the sins of Manasseh, according to all that he had done,</p> |
| <p>4 And also for the innocent blood that he shed: for he filled Jerusalem with innocent blood; which the LORD would not pardon.</p> | <p>Also for the innocent blood that He had shed. For He filled Jerusalem with innocent blood. The LORD would not pardon.</p> |
| <p>5 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?</p> | <p>Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim and all that he did, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah?</p> |
| <p>6 So Jehoiakim slept with his fathers: and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his stead.</p> | <p>So Jehoiakim slept with his fathers, and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place.</p> |
| <p>7 And the king of Egypt came not again any more out of his land: for the king of Babylon had taken from the river of Egypt unto the river Euphrates all that pertained to the king of Egypt.</p> | <p>The king of Egypt did not come again out of his land, for the king of Babylon had taken all that belonged to the king of Egypt from the Brook of Egypt to the river Euphrates.</p> |

- 8 *Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. And his mother's name was Nehushta, the daughter of Elnathan of Jerusalem.* Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he became king. He reigned three months in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Nehushta the daughter of Elnathan of Jerusalem.
- 9 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father had done.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that His father had done.
- 10 *At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up against Jerusalem, and the city was besieged.* At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up to Jerusalem, and the city was besieged.
- 11 *And Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came against the city, and his servants did besiege it.* Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to the city while his servants were besieging it,
- 12 *And Jehoiachin the king of Judah went out to the king of Babylon, he, and his mother, and his servants, and his princes, and his officers: and the king of Babylon took him in the eighth year of his reign.* Jehoiachin the king of Judah gave himself up to the king of Babylon, himself and his mother and his servants and his officials and his palace officials. The king of Babylon took him prisoner in the eighth year of his reign
- 13 *And he carried out thence all the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house, and cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon king of Israel had made in the temple of the LORD, as the LORD had said.* Carried off all the treasures of the house of the LORD and the treasures of the king's house, and cut in pieces all the vessels of gold in the temple of the LORD, which Solomon king of Israel had made, as the LORD had foretold.

- 14 *And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the mighty men of valour, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and smiths: none remained, save the poorest sort of the people of the land.* He carried away all Jerusalem and all the officials and all the mighty men of valor, ten thousand captives. All the craftsmen and the smiths. None remained, except the poorest people of the land.
- 15 *And he carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, and the king's mother, and the king's wives, and his officers, and the mighty of the land, those carried he into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon.* He carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon. The king's mother, the king's wives, his officials, and the chief men of the land he took into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon.
- 16 *And all the men of might, even seven thousand, and craftsmen and smiths a thousand, all that were strong and apt for war, even them the king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon.* The king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon all the men of valor, 7,000, and the craftsmen and the metal workers, 1,000, all of them strong and fit for war.
- 17 *And the king of Babylon made Mattaniah his father's brother king in his stead, and changed his name to Zedekiah.* The king of Babylon made Mattaniah, Jehoiachin's uncle, king in his place, and changed his name to Zedekiah.
- 18 *Zedekiah was twenty and one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.* Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he became king. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.
- 19 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.
- 20 *For through the anger of the LORD it came to pass in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence, that Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.* For because of the anger of the LORD it came to the point in Jerusalem and Judah that He cast them out from His presence. And Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Dan 1:1; Jer 25:1; Jer 25:9
- v2 — Jer 35:11; 2 Kgs 23:27
- v7 — Jer 37:5-7; Jer 46:2
- v8 — 1 Chr 3:16; 2 Chr 36:9
- v12 — Jer 24:1; Jer 52:28
- v13 — Isa 39:6; Jer 20:5; 2 Kgs 20:17
- v14 — Jer 52:28; 2 Kgs 25:12
- v17 — Jer 37:1
- v18 — 2 Kgs 23:31

Chapter 25

Zedekiah rebelled against Babylon, and Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem for two years until famine overwhelmed the city. The temple was burned, the walls torn down, and the people carried into exile; Gedaliah was appointed governor but was assassinated, and the remnant fled to Egypt.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he, and all his host, against Jerusalem, and pitched against it; and they built forts against it round about.</i></p> | <p>In the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, on the tenth day of the month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came with all his army against Jerusalem and laid siege to it. And they built siegeworks all around it.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the city was besieged unto the eleventh year of king Zedekiah.</i></p> | <p>So the city was besieged till the eleventh year of King Zedekiah.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And on the ninth day of the fourth month the famine prevailed in the city, and there was no bread for the people of the land.</i></p> | <p>On the ninth day of the fourth month the famine was so severe in the city that there was no food for the people of the land.</p> |

- 4 *And the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between two walls, which is by the king's garden: (now the Chaldees were against the city round about:) and the king went the way toward the plain.* Then a breach was made in the city. All the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, by the king's garden, and the Chaldeans were around the city. And they went in the direction of the Arabah.
- 5 *And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all his army were scattered from him.* But the army of the Chaldeans pursued the king and overtook him in the plains of Jericho. All his army was scattered from him.
- 6 *So they took the king, and brought him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah; and they gave judgment upon him.* Then they captured the king and brought him up to the king of Babylon at Riblah. They passed sentence on him.
- 7 *And they slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and put out the eyes of Zedekiah, and bound him with fetters of brass, and carried him to Babylon.* They slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and put out the eyes of Zedekiah and bound him in chains and took him to Babylon.
- 8 *And in the fifth month, on the seventh day of the month, which is the nineteenth year of king Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, came Nebuzaradan, captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, unto Jerusalem:* In the fifth month, on the seventh day of the month—that was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon—Nebuzaradan, the captain of the bodyguard, a servant of the king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem.
- 9 *And he burnt the house of the LORD, and the king's house, and all the houses of Jerusalem, and every great man's house burnt he with fire.* He burned the house of the LORD and the king's house and all the houses of Jerusalem; every great house He burned down.
- 10 *And all the army of the Chaldees, that were with the captain of the guard, brake down the walls of Jerusalem round about.* All the army of the Chaldeans, who were with the captain of the guard, broke down the walls around Jerusalem.

- 11 *Now the rest of the people that were left in the city, and the fugitives that fell away to the king of Babylon, with the remnant of the multitude, did Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carry away.* The rest of the people who were left in the city and the deserters who had deserted to the king of Babylon, together with the rest of the crowd, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried into exile.
- 12 *But the captain of the guard left of the poor of the land to be vinedressers and husbandmen.* But the captain of the guard left some of the poorest of the land to be vinedressers and plowmen.
- 13 *And the pillars of brass that were in the house of the LORD, and the bases, and the brasen sea that was in the house of the LORD, did the Chaldees break in pieces, and carried the brass of them to Babylon.* The pillars of bronze that were in the house of the LORD, and the stands and the bronze sea that were in the house of the LORD, the Chaldeans broke in pieces and carried the bronze to Babylon.
- 14 *And the pots, and the shovels, and the snuffers, and the spoons, and all the vessels of brass wherewith they ministered, took they away.* They took away the pots and the shovels and the snuffers and the dishes for incense and all the vessels of bronze used in the temple service,
- 15 *And the firepans, and the basons, and such things as were of gold, in gold, and of silver, in silver, the captain of the guard took away.* The fire pans also and the basins. What was of gold the captain of the guard took away as gold, and what was of silver, as silver.
- 16 *The two pillars, one sea, and the bases which Solomon had made for the house of the LORD; the brass of all these vessels was without weight.* As for the two pillars, the one sea, and the stands that Solomon had made for the house of the LORD, the bronze of all these vessels was beyond weight.
- 17 *The height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits, and the chapter upon it was brass: and the height of the chapter three cubits; and the wreathen work, and pomegranates upon the chapter round about, all of brass: and like unto these had the second pillar with wreathen work.* The height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits, and on it was a capital of bronze. The height of the capital was three cubits. A latticework and pomegranates, all of bronze, were all around the capital. And the second pillar had the same, with the latticework.

- 18 *And the captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the door:* The captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest and Zephaniah the second priest and the three keepers of the threshold;
- 19 *And out of the city he took an officer that was set over the men of war, and five men of them that were in the king's presence, which were found in the city, and the principal scribe of the host, which mustered the people of the land, and threescore men of the people of the land that were found in the city:* From the city he took an officer who had been in command of the men of war, and five men of the king's council who were found in the city. The secretary of the commander of the army, who mustered the people of the land. Sixty men of the people of the land who were found in the city.
- 20 *And Nebuzaradan captain of the guard took these, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah:* Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard took them and brought them to the king of Babylon at Riblah.
- 21 *And the king of Babylon smote them, and slew them at Riblah in the land of Hamath. So Judah was carried away out of their land.* The king of Babylon struck them down and put them to death at Riblah in the land of Hamath. So Judah was taken into exile out of its land.
- 22 *And as for the people that remained in the land of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had left, even over them he made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, ruler.* Over the people who remained in the land of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had left, he appointed Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, son of Shaphan, governor.

- 23 *And when all the captains of the armies, they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah governor, there came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and Johanan the son of Careah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth the Netophathite, and Jaazaniah the son of a Maachathite, they and their men.* Now when all the captains of the forces in the open country and their men heard that the king of Babylon had appointed Gedaliah governor, they came with their men to Gedaliah at Mizpah, namely, Ishmael the son of Netaniah, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth the Netophathite, and Jaazaniah the son of the Maacathite.
- 24 *And Gedaliah sware to them, and to their men, and said unto them, Fear not to be the servants of the Chaldees: dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon; and it shall be well with you.* Gedaliah swore to them and their men, saying, "Do not be afraid because of the Chaldean officials. Live in the land and serve the king of Babylon. It will be well with you."
- 25 *But it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of the seed royal, came, and ten men with him, and smote Gedaliah, that he died, and the Jews and the Chaldees that were with him at Mizpah.* But in the seventh month, Ishmael the son of Netaniah, son of Elishama, of the royal family, came with ten men and struck down Gedaliah and put him to death along with the Jews and the Chaldeans who were with him at Mizpah.
- 26 *And all the people, both small and great, and the captains of the armies, arose, and came to Egypt: for they were afraid of the Chaldees.* Then all the people, both small and great, and the captains of the forces arose and went to Egypt, for they were afraid of the Chaldeans.
- 27 *And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, on the seven and twentieth day of the month, that Evilmerodach king of Babylon in the year that he began to reign did lift up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah out of prison;* In the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month, Evil-merodach king of Babylon, in the year that he began to reign, graciously freed Jehoiachin king of Judah from prison.

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| <p>28 <i>And he spake kindly to him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon;</i></p> <p>29 <i>And changed his prison garments: and he did eat bread continually before him all the days of his life.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And his allowance was a continual allowance given him of the king, a daily rate for every day, all the days of his life.</i></p> | <p>He spoke kindly to him and gave him a seat above the seats of the kings who were with him in Babylon.</p> <p>So Jehoiachin put off his prison garments. And every day of his life he dined regularly at the king's table,</p> <p>For his allowance, a regular allowance was given him by the king, according to his daily needs, as long as he lived.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ishmael (*ISH-mee-el*) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Cross-References:

- v6 — 2 Kgs 23:33
- v9 — Amos 2:5; Ps 74:3-7
- v10 — Neh 1:3
- v12 — Jer 40:7; 2 Kgs 24:14
- v14 — Ex 27:3
- v18 — 1 Chr 6:14; Ezra 7:1; Jer 29:25; Jer 21:1
- v21 — Deut 28:64; 2 Kgs 23:27
- v22 — Jer 39:14
- v27 — Gen 40:20; Jer 52:31-34; Gen 40:13; 2 Kgs 24:12; Prov 21:1
- v28 — Dan 2:37; Jer 27:6-11; Dan 5:18-19
- v29 — 2 Sam 9:7; Isa 61:3; Gen 41:42; 2 Kgs 24:12; Zech 3:4
- v30 — Luke 11:3; Neh 11:23; Matt 6:11; Neh 12:47; Dan 1:5

1 Chronicles

Author: *Ezra the priest, traditionally — compiling and editing court records, genealogical registers, and prophetic writings into a unified account for the returned exiles.*

Date written: *c. 450–430 BC.*

Written to: *The post-exilic community in Jerusalem, who had returned from Babylon and needed to reconnect with their heritage and their God.*

Setting: *The exiles have returned from Babylon but the nation is a shadow of its former self. The Chronicler writes to help them understand who they are — children of Abraham, heirs of David, stewards of the temple.*

Where this sits historically: *Written c. 450 BC during the Persian period after the return from exile, but retells David's reign (c. 1010–970 BC) as a priestly retrospective for the restoration community.*

Contemporaries: *Of writing — Ezra, Nehemiah, Haggai, Zechariah, and Malachi — the post-exilic community under Persian rule. The events recounted parallel 2 Samuel.*

Big themes:

- Genealogy as identity — the long genealogies of chapters 1–9 are not filler; they anchor the returned community to every generation from Adam forward
- David — 1 Chronicles is almost entirely devoted to David's reign, with particular focus on his preparations for the temple
- Worship — the organization of the Levites, singers, priests, and gatekeepers shows that proper worship is as important as military or political strength
- The ark — David's desire to bring the ark to Jerusalem and his care in doing it correctly dominates the middle chapters
- Divine election — God chose David, chose Jerusalem, chose the tribe of Judah; the Chronicler keeps this to the foreground

Key passages: *1 Chr 1:1; 17:11–14; 22:9–10; 28:9; 29:14*

How it fits: *Chronicles covers the same period as Samuel and Kings but was written after the exile with a different purpose: not to explain why Israel fell, but to give the restoration community a foundation for worship and hope. 1 Chronicles ends at David's death, with the temple project fully planned and handed to Solomon.*

Chapter 1

The genealogy traces the line of the nations from Adam through Noah's three sons, then narrows to Abraham through Esau and the chiefs of Edom.

1 Adam, Sheth, Enosh, Adam, Seth, Enosh,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Adam** (AD-um) — "man, earth" — *The first man, created by God from the dust of the ground. 1 Chronicles begins its genealogy with him to trace the line of God's covenant people from creation itself down to David.*

2 Kenan, Mahalaleel, Jered, Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared,
3 Henoch, Methuselah, Lamech, Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech,
4 Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Noah** (NOH-ah) — "rest, comfort" — *The righteous man who built the ark and preserved humanity and the animal kingdom through the great flood. Through his son Shem, the line of promise continues to Abraham and ultimately to Christ.*

5 The sons of Japheth; Gomer, and The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog,
Magog, and Madai, and Javan, and Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and
Tubal, and Meshech, and Tiras. Tiras.
6 And the sons of Gomer; Ashchenaz, The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz,
and Riphath, and Togarmah. Riphath, and Togarmah.
7 And the sons of Javan; Elishah, and The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish,
Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim. Kittim, and Dodanim.
8 The sons of Ham; Cush, and Mizraim, The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Put,
Put, and Canaan. and Canaan.
9 And the sons of Cush; Seba, and The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah,
Havilah, and Sabta, and Raamah, and Sabta, Raamah, and Sabteca. The sons
Sabteca. And the sons of Raamah; of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan.
Sheba, and Dedan.
10 And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to Cush begat Nimrod. He was the first to
be mighty upon the earth. be a mighty man on the earth.
11 And Mizraim begat Ludim, and Mizraim begat Ludim, Ananim,
Ananim, and Lehabim, and Lehabim, Naphtuhim,
Naphtuhim,
12 And Pathrusim, and Casluhim, (of Pathrusim, Casluhim (from whom the
whom came the Philistines,) and Philistines came), and Capthorim.
Caphthorim.

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| 13 <i>And Canaan begat Zidon his firstborn, and Heth,</i> | Canaan begat Sidon his firstborn, and Heth, |
| 14 <i>The Jebusite also, and the Amorite, and the Girgashite,</i> | The Jebusite, the Amorite, the Girgashite, |
| 15 <i>And the Hivite, and the Arkite, and the Sinite,</i> | The Hivite, the Arkite, the Sinite, |
| 16 <i>And the Arvadite, and the Zemarite, and the Hamathite.</i> | The Arvadite, the Zemarite, and the Hamathite. |
| 17 <i>The sons of Shem; Elam, and Asshur, and Arphaxad, and Lud, and Aram, and Uz, and Hul, and Gether, and Meshech.</i> | The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech. |
| 18 <i>And Arphaxad begat Shelah, and Shelah begat Eber.</i> | Arphaxad begat Shelah, and Shelah begat Eber. |
| 19 <i>And unto Eber were born two sons: the name of the one was Peleg; because in his days the earth was divided: and his brother's name was Joktan.</i> | To Eber were born two sons: the name of the one was Peleg, for in his days the earth was divided. His brother's name was Joktan. |
| 20 <i>And Joktan begat Almodad, and Sheleph, and Hazarmaveth, and Jerah,</i> | Joktan begat Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, |
| 21 <i>Hadoram also, and Uzal, and Diklah,</i> | Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, |
| 22 <i>And Ebal, and Abimael, and Sheba,</i> | Ebal, Abimael, Sheba, |
| 23 <i>And Ophir, and Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan.</i> | Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan. |
| 24 <i>Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah,</i> | Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah, |
| 25 <i>Eber, Peleg, Reu,</i> | Eber, Peleg, Reu, |
| 26 <i>Serug, Nahor, Terah,</i> | Serug, Nahor, Terah, |
| 27 <i>Abram; the same is Abraham.</i> | Abram, that is, Abraham. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Abraham** (AY-brah-ham) — "father of a multitude" — Originally Abram ("exalted father"), renamed by God when He established an everlasting covenant with him (Genesis 17). The father of the faithful, through whom all the families of the earth would be blessed. The genealogy narrows here from all humanity to Abraham's line.

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| 28 <i>The sons of Abraham; Isaac, and Ishmael.</i> | The sons of Abraham: Isaac and Ishmael. |
| 29 <i>These are their generations: The firstborn of Ishmael, Nebaioth; then Kedar, and Adbeel, and Mibsam,</i> | These are their genealogies: the firstborn of Ishmael was Nebaioth; then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, |
| 30 <i>Mishma, and Dumah, Massa, Hadad, and Tema,</i> | Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, and Tema, |
| 31 <i>Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah. These are the sons of Ishmael.</i> | Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah. These are the sons of Ishmael. |
| 32 <i>Now the sons of Keturah, Abraham's concubine: she bare Zimran, and Jokshan, and Medan, and Midian, and Ishbak, and Shuah. And the sons of Jokshan; Sheba, and Dedan.</i> | The sons of Keturah, Abraham's concubine: she bore Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. The sons of Jokshan: Sheba and Dedan. |
| 33 <i>And the sons of Midian; Ephah, and Ephraim, and Henoah, and Abida, and Eldaah. All these are the sons of Keturah.</i> | The sons of Midian: Ephah, Ephraim, Hanoah, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the sons of Keturah. |
| 34 <i>And Abraham begat Isaac. The sons of Isaac; Esau and Israel.</i> | Abraham begat Isaac. The sons of Isaac: Esau and Israel. |
| 35 <i>The sons of Esau; Eliphaz, Reuel, and Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah.</i> | The sons of Esau: Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. |
| 36 <i>The sons of Eliphaz; Teman, and Omar, Zephi, and Gatam, Kenaz, and Timna, and Amalek.</i> | The sons of Eliphaz: Teman, Omar, Zephi, Gatam, Kenaz, Timna, and Amalek. |
| 37 <i>The sons of Reuel; Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah.</i> | The sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. |
| 38 <i>And the sons of Seir; Lotan, and Shobal, and Zibeon, and Anah, and Dishon, and Ezar, and Dishan.</i> | The sons of Seir: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. |

- 39 *And the sons of Lotan; Hori, and Homam: and Timna was Lotan's sister.* The sons of Lotan: Hori and Homam. Lotan's sister was Timna.
- 40 *The sons of Shobal; Alian, and Manahath, and Ebal, Shephi, and Onam. And the sons of Zibeon; Aiah, and Anah.* The sons of Shobal: Alian, Manahath, Ebal, Shephi, and Onam. The sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah.
- 41 *The sons of Anah; Dishon. And the sons of Dishon; Amram, and Eshban, and Ithran, and Cheran.* The son of Anah: Dishon. The sons of Dishon: Hamran, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran.
- 42 *The sons of Ezer; Bilhan, and Zavan, and Jakan. The sons of Dishan; Uz, and Aran.* The sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Jaakan. The sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.
- 43 *Now these are the kings that reigned in the land of Edom before any king reigned over the children of Israel; Bela the son of Beor: and the name of his city was Dinhabah.* These are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom before any king reigned over the people of Israel: Bela the son of Beor, and the name of his city was Dinhabah.
- 44 *And when Bela was dead, Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his stead.* When Bela died, Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his place.
- 45 *And when Jobab was dead, Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his stead.* When Jobab died, Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his place.
- 46 *And when Husham was dead, Hadad the son of Bedad, which smote Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Avith.* When Husham died, Hadad the son of Bedad, who defeated Midian in the fields of Moab, reigned in his place. The name of his city was Avith.
- 47 *And when Hadad was dead, Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his stead.* When Hadad died, Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his place.
- 48 *And when Samlah was dead, Shaul of Rehoboth by the river reigned in his stead.* When Samlah died, Shaul of Rehoboth by the Euphrates reigned in his place.

49	<i>And when Shaul was dead, Baalhanan the son of Achbor reigned in his stead.</i>	When Shaul died, Baal-hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his place.
50	<i>And when Baalhanan was dead, Hadad reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Pai; and his wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab.</i>	When Baal-hanan died, Hadad reigned in his place. The name of his city was Pai. his wife's name was Mehetabel the daughter of Matred, daughter of Mezahab.
51	<i>Hadad died also. And the dukes of Edom were; duke Timnah, duke Aliah, duke Jetheth,</i>	Hadad died. The chiefs of Edom were: chief Timnah, chief Aliah, chief Jetheth,
52	<i>Duke Aholibamah, duke Elah, duke Pinon,</i>	Chief Aholibamah, chief Elah, chief Pinon,
53	<i>Duke Kenaz, duke Teman, duke Mibzar,</i>	Chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief Mibzar,
54	<i>Duke Magdiel, duke Iram. These are the dukes of Edom.</i>	Chief Magdiel, and chief Iram. These are the chiefs of Edom.

Words in this chapter:

- Philistines** (*FIL-ih-steenz*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'
- Abram** (*AY-bram*) — The original name of Abraham, meaning 'exalted father' — God later changed it to Abraham when He gave the covenant of circumcision.
- Adam** (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'
- Enoch** (*EE-nok*) — A man who 'walked with God' — he did not die but was taken by God; ancestor of Noah; father of Methuselah.
- Esau** (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.
- Ham** (*HAM*) — Noah's second son — ancestor of the Canaanites and African peoples; cursed through his son Canaan for dishonoring Noah.
- Isaac** (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 4:25-5:32; Luke 3:38

v2 — Luke 3:37
v4 — Gen 5:32
v25 — Luke 3:35
v50 — Gen 36:39

Chapter 2

The genealogy traces the sons of Israel (Jacob), then focuses on the line of Judah through Perez and Hezron down to Jesse and David, with the clans of Caleb and Jerahmeel.

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| 1 | <i>These are the sons of Israel; Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun,</i> | These are the sons of Israel: Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, |
| 2 | <i>Dan, Joseph, and Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.</i> | Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher. |
| 3 | <i>The sons of Judah; Er, and Onan, and Shelah: which three were born unto him of the daughter of Shua the Canaanitess. And Er, the firstborn of Judah, was evil in the sight of the LORD; and he slew him.</i> | The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, and Shelah — these three were born to Him by the daughter of Shua the Canaanitess. And Er, the firstborn of Judah, was evil in the sight of the LORD. He put Him to death. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Judah** (JOO-dah) — "praise" — Jacob's fourth son, from whom the royal tribe descends. The Chronicler gives Judah's genealogy first and at greatest length because from Judah come David and the messianic line. The southern kingdom bears his name.

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| 4 | <i>And Tamar his daughter in law bare him Pharez and Zerah. All the sons of Judah were five.</i> | Tamar His daughter-in-law bore Him Perez and Zerah. All the sons of Judah were five. |
| 5 | <i>The sons of Pharez; Hezron, and Hamul.</i> | The sons of Perez: Hezron and Hamul. |
| 6 | <i>And the sons of Zerah; Zimri, and Ethan, and Heman, and Calcol, and Dara: five of them in all.</i> | The sons of Zerah: Zimri, Ethan, Heman, Calcol, and Dara — five in all. |
| 7 | <i>And the sons of Carmi; Achar, the troubler of Israel, who transgressed in the thing accursed.</i> | The son of Carmi: Achar, the troubler of Israel, who broke faith in the matter of the devoted thing. |
| 8 | <i>And the sons of Ethan; Azariah.</i> | The son of Ethan: Azariah. |

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| <p>9 <i>The sons also of Hezron, that were born unto him; Jerahmeel, and Ram, and Chelubai.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Ram begat Amminadab; and Amminadab begat Nahshon, prince of the children of Judah;</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Nahshon begat Salma, and Salma begat Boaz,</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Boaz begat Obed, and Obed begat Jesse,</i></p> <p>13 <i>And Jesse begat his firstborn Eliab, and Abinadab the second, and Shimma the third,</i></p> <p>14 <i>Nethaneel the fourth, Raddai the fifth,</i></p> <p>15 <i>Ozem the sixth, David the seventh:</i></p> | <p>The sons of Hezron who were born to him: Jerahmeel, Ram, and Chelubai.</p> <p>Ram begat Amminadab, and Amminadab begat Nahshon, prince of the sons of Judah.</p> <p>Nahshon begat Salma, and Salma begat Boaz.</p> <p>Boaz begat Obed, and Obed begat Jesse.</p> <p>Jesse begat Eliab his firstborn, Abinadab the second, Shimea the third,</p> <p>Nethanel the fourth, Raddai the fifth,</p> <p>Ozem the sixth, David the seventh.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **David** (DAY-vid) — "beloved" — *The seventh son of Jesse, Israel's greatest king. The Chronicler's entire work revolves around David — his genealogy, his reign, his preparations for the temple, and the dynasty God promised would endure forever. In Chronicles, David is presented as the ideal king and worshiper.*

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| <p>16 <i>Whose sisters were Zeruiah, and Abigail. And the sons of Zeruiah; Abishai, and Joab, and Asahel, three.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And Abigail bare Amasa: and the father of Amasa was Jether the Ishmeelite.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And Caleb the son of Hezron begat children of Azubah his wife, and of Jerioth: her sons are these; Jeshur, and Shobab, and Ardon.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And when Azubah was dead, Caleb took unto him Ephrath, which bare him Hur.</i></p> | <p>Their sisters were Zeruiah and Abigail. The sons of Zeruiah: Abishai, Joab, and Asahel — three.</p> <p>Abigail bore Amasa, and the father of Amasa was Jether the Ishmaelite.</p> <p>Caleb the son of Hezron begat children by Azubah his wife and by Jerioth. These were her sons: Jeshur, Shobab, and Ardon.</p> <p>When Azubah died, Caleb married Ephrath, who bore him Hur.</p> |
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- 20 *And Hur begat Uri, and Uri begat Bezaleel.* Hur begat Uri, and Uri begat Bezalel.
- 21 *And afterward Hezron went in to the daughter of Machir the father of Gilead, whom he married when he was threescore years old; and she bare him Segub.* Afterward Hezron went in to the daughter of Machir the father of Gilead, whom he married when he was sixty years old. She bore him Segub.
- 22 *And Segub begat Jair, who had three and twenty cities in the land of Gilead.* Segub begat Jair, who had twenty-three cities in the land of Gilead.
- 23 *And he took Geshur, and Aram, with the towns of Jair, from them, with Kenath, and the towns thereof, even threescore cities. All these belonged to the sons of Machir the father of Gilead.* He took Geshur and Aram, with the towns of Jair, along with Kenath and its villages — sixty towns in all. All these belonged to the sons of Machir the father of Gilead.
- 24 *And after that Hezron was dead in Calebephratah, then Abiah Hezron's wife bare him Ashhur the father of Tekoa.* After Hezron died in Caleb-ephraiah, Abijah, Hezron's wife, bore him Ashhur the father of Tekoa.
- 25 *And the sons of Jerahmeel the firstborn of Hezron were, Ram the firstborn, and Bunah, and Oren, and Ozem, and Ahijah.* The sons of Jerahmeel the firstborn of Hezron: Ram the firstborn, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah.
- 26 *Jerahmeel had also another wife, whose name was Atarah; she was the mother of Onam.* Jerahmeel had another wife whose name was Atarah; she was the mother of Onam.
- 27 *And the sons of Ram the firstborn of Jerahmeel were, Maaz, and Jamin, and Eker.* The sons of Ram the firstborn of Jerahmeel: Maaz, Jamin, and Eker.
- 28 *And the sons of Onam were, Shammai, and Jada. And the sons of Shammai; Nadab, and Abishur.* The sons of Onam: Shammai and Jada. The sons of Shammai: Nadab and Abishur.

- 29 *And the name of the wife of Abishur was Abihail, and she bare him Ahban, and Molid.* The name of Abishur's wife was Abihail. She bore him Ahban and Molid.
- 30 *And the sons of Nadab; Seled, and Appaim: but Seled died without children.* The sons of Nadab: Seled and Appaim. Seled died without children.
- 31 *And the sons of Appaim; Ishi. And the sons of Ishi; Sheshan. And the children of Sheshan; Ahlai.* The son of Appaim: Ishi. The son of Ishi: Sheshan. The son of Sheshan: Ahlai.
- 32 *And the sons of Jada the brother of Shammai; Jether, and Jonathan: and Jether died without children.* The sons of Jada, the brother of Shammai: Jether and Jonathan. Jether died without children.
- 33 *And the sons of Jonathan; Peleth, and Zaza. These were the sons of Jerahmeel.* The sons of Jonathan: Peleth and Zaza. These were the sons of Jerahmeel.
- 34 *Now Sheshan had no sons, but daughters. And Sheshan had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Jarha.* Now Sheshan had no sons, only daughters. And Sheshan had an Egyptian servant whose name was Jarha.
- 35 *And Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha his servant to wife; and she bare him Attai.* Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha his servant as wife. She bore him Attai.
- 36 *And Attai begat Nathan, and Nathan begat Zabad,* Attai begat Nathan, Nathan begat Zabad,
- 37 *And Zabad begat Ephlal, and Ephlal begat Obed,* Zabad begat Ephlal, Ephlal begat Obed,
- 38 *And Obed begat Jehu, and Jehu begat Azariah,* Obed begat Jehu, Jehu begat Azariah,
- 39 *And Azariah begat Helez, and Helez begat Eleasah,* Azariah begat Helez, Helez begat Eleasah,
- 40 *And Eleasah begat Sisamai, and Sisamai begat Shallum,* Eleasah begat Sismai, Sismai begat Shallum,

- 41 *And Shallum begat Jekamiah, and Jekamiah begat Elishama.* Shallum begat Jekamiah, and Jekamiah begat Elishama.
- 42 *Now the sons of Caleb the brother of Jerahmeel were, Mesha his firstborn, which was the father of Ziph; and the sons of Mareshah the father of Hebron.* The sons of Caleb the brother of Jerahmeel: Mesha his firstborn, who was the father of Ziph. The sons of Mareshah the father of Hebron.
- 43 *And the sons of Hebron; Korah, and Tappuah, and Rekem, and Shema.* The sons of Hebron: Korah, Tappuah, Rekem, and Shema.
- 44 *And Shema begat Raham, the father of Jorkoam: and Rekem begat Shammai.* Shema begat Raham the father of Jorkoam, and Rekem begat Shammai.
- 45 *And the son of Shammai was Maon: and Maon was the father of Bethzur.* The son of Shammai was Maon, and Maon was the father of Beth-zur.
- 46 *And Ephah, Caleb's concubine, bare Haran, and Moza, and Gazez: and Haran begat Gazez.* Ephah, Caleb's concubine, bore Haran, Moza, and Gazez. Haran begat Gazez.
- 47 *And the sons of Jahdai; Regem, and Jotham, and Geshan, and Pelet, and Ephah, and Shaaph.* The sons of Jahdai: Regem, Jotham, Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, and Shaaph.
- 48 *Maachah, Caleb's concubine, bare Sheber, and Tirhanah.* Maacah, Caleb's concubine, bore Sheber and Tirhanah.
- 49 *She bare also Shaaph the father of Madmannah, Sheva the father of Machbenah, and the father of Gibeaz: and the daughter of Caleb was Achsah.* She also bore Shaaph the father of Madmannah, Sheva the father of Machbenah and the father of Gibeaz. The daughter of Caleb was Achsah.
- 50 *These were the sons of Caleb the son of Hur, the firstborn of Ephrathah; Shobal the father of Kirjathjearim,* These were the sons of Caleb. The sons of Hur the firstborn of Ephrathah: Shobal the father of Kiriath-jearim,
- 51 *Salma the father of Bethlehem, Hareph the father of Bethgader.* Salma the father of Bethlehem, and Hareph the father of Beth-gader.
- 52 *And Shobal the father of Kirjathjearim had sons; Haroeh, and half of the Manahethites.* Shobal the father of Kiriath-jearim had sons: Haroeh, half of the Manahathites,

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| 53 | <i>And the families of Kirjathjearim; the Ithrites, and the Puhites, and the Shumathites, and the Mishraites; of them came the Zareathites, and the Eshtaulites.</i> | The families of Kiriath-jearim: the Ithrites, the Puthites, the Shumathites, and the Mishraites; from these came the Zorathites and the Eshtaulites. |
| 54 | <i>The sons of Salma; Bethlehem, and the Netophathites, Ataroth, the house of Joab, and half of the Manahethites, the Zorites.</i> | The sons of Salma: Bethlehem, the Netophathites, Atroth-beth-joab, and half of the Manahathites, the Zorites. |
| 55 | <i>And the families of the scribes which dwelt at Jabez; the Tirathites, the Shimeathites, and Suchathites. These are the Kenites that came of Hemath, the father of the house of Rechab.</i> | The families of the scribes who lived at Jabez: the Tirathites, the Shimeathites, and the Sucathites. These are the Kenites who came from Hammath, the father of the house of Rechab. |

Words in this chapter:

Kenites (*KEE-nytes*) — A nomadic people related to Moses's father-in-law Jethro — they accompanied Israel and settled in the south; Jael who killed Sisera was a Kenite woman.

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Boaz (*BO-az*) — A wealthy landowner in Bethlehem who married Ruth — he acted as her kinsman-redeemer; ancestor of King David; his name means 'in him is strength.'

Caleb (*KAY-leb*) — One of the twelve spies who gave a faithful report and urged Israel to trust God — he and Joshua alone of his generation entered the Promised Land.

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 32:28; Rev 7:5-8; Gen 35:22-26

v3 — Gen 38:2-10

v4 — Matt 1:3

v10 — Matt 1:4

v17 — 2 Sam 17:25

v55 — Judg 1:16; 2 Kgs 10:15

Chapter 3

The genealogy lists the sons of David born in Hebron and Jerusalem, then traces the royal line from Solomon through the kings of Judah down to the descendants of Jeconiah after the exile.

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| <p>1 <i>Now these were the sons of David, which were born unto him in Hebron; the firstborn Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; the second Daniel, of Abigail the Carmelitess:</i></p> | <p>These are the sons of David who were born to him in Hebron: the firstborn Amnon, by Ahinoam the Jezreelite; the second Daniel, by Abigail the Carmelite;</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The third, Absalom the son of Maachah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur: the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith:</i></p> | <p>The third Absalom, whose mother was Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur; the fourth Adonijah, whose mother was Haggith;</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The fifth, Shephatiah of Abital: the sixth, Ithream by Eglah his wife.</i></p> | <p>The fifth Shephatiah, by Abital; the sixth Ithream, by his wife Eglah.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>These six were born unto him in Hebron; and there he reigned seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years.</i></p> | <p>Six were born to him in Hebron, where he reigned for seven years and six months. Then he reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And these were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shimea, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, four, of Bathshua the daughter of Ammiel:</i></p> | <p>These were born to him in Jerusalem: Shimea, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon — four by Bathshua the daughter of Ammiel;</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Ibhar also, and Elishama, and Eliphelet,</i></p> | <p>Then Ibhar, Elishama, Eliphelet,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia,</i></p> | <p>Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia,</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And Elishama, and Eliada, and Eliphelet, nine.</i></p> | <p>Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet — nine.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>These were all the sons of David, beside the sons of the concubines, and Tamar their sister.</i></p> | <p>These were all the sons of David, besides the sons of the concubines. Tamar was their sister.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And Solomon's son was Rehoboam, Abia his son, Asa his son, Jehoshaphat his son,</i></p> | <p>Solomon's son was Rehoboam; Abijah his son, Asa his son, Jehoshaphat his son,</p> |

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| <p>11 <i>Joram his son, Ahaziah his son, Joash his son,</i></p> <p>12 <i>Amaziah his son, Azariah his son, Jotham his son,</i></p> <p>13 <i>Ahaz his son, Hezekiah his son, Manasseh his son,</i></p> <p>14 <i>Amon his son, Josiah his son.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the sons of Josiah were, the firstborn Johanan, the second Jehoiakim, the third Zedekiah, the fourth Shallum.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his son, Zedekiah his son.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the sons of Jeconiah; Assir, Salathiel his son,</i></p> <p>18 <i>Malchiram also, and Pedaiah, and Shenazar, Jecamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the sons of Pedaiah were, Zerubbabel, and Shimei: and the sons of Zerubbabel; Meshullam, and Hananiah, and Shelomith their sister:</i></p> <p>20 <i>And Hashubah, and Ohel, and Berechiah, and Hasadiah, Jushabhesed, five.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And the sons of Hananiah; Pelatiah, and Jesaiah: the sons of Rephaiah, the sons of Arnan, the sons of Obadiah, the sons of Shechaniah.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the sons of Shechaniah; Shemaiah: and the sons of Shemaiah; Hattush, and Igeal, and Bariah, and Neariah, and Shaphat, six.</i></p> | <p>Joram his son, Ahaziah his son, Joash his son,</p> <p>Amaziah his son, Azariah his son, Jotham his son,</p> <p>Ahaz his son, Hezekiah his son, Manasseh his son,</p> <p>Amon his son, Josiah his son.</p> <p>The sons of Josiah: the firstborn Johanan, the second Jehoiakim, the third Zedekiah, the fourth Shallum.</p> <p>The sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his son, Zedekiah his son.</p> <p>The sons of Jeconiah the captive: Assir, Shealtiel his son,</p> <p>Malchiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah.</p> <p>The sons of Pedaiah: Zerubbabel and Shimei. The sons of Zerubbabel: Meshullam and Hananiah, and Shelomith was their sister;</p> <p>Also Hashubah, Ohel, Berechiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab-hesed — five.</p> <p>The sons of Hananiah: Pelatiah and Jeshaiiah, the sons of Rephaiah, the sons of Arnan, the sons of Obadiah, the sons of Shecaniah.</p> <p>The son of Shecaniah: Shemaiah. The sons of Shemaiah: Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat — six.</p> |
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And the sons of Neariah; Elioenai, and Hezekiah, and Azrikam, three.

The sons of Neariah: Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam — three.
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And the sons of Elioenai were, Hodaiah, and Eliashib, and Pelaiah, and Akkub, and Johanan, and Dalaiah, and Anani, seven.

The sons of Elioenai: Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan, Delaiah, and Anani — seven.

Words in this chapter:

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Zerubbabel (*zeh-RUB-ah-bel*) — The governor who led the first return of exiles from Babylon — laid the foundation of the second temple; his name means 'born in Babylon' or 'seed of Babylon.'

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

v4 — 2 Sam 2:11; 2 Sam 5:4-5

v5 — 2 Sam 11:3

v8 — 1 Chr 14:7

Chapter 4

The genealogy continues the clans of Judah, including the prayer of Jabez who asked God to enlarge his territory, and records the families and settlements of Simeon.

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The sons of Judah; Pharez, Hezron, and Carmi, and Hur, and Shobal.

The sons of Judah: Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal.

- 2 *And Reaiah the son of Shobal begat Jahath; and Jahath begat Ahumai, and Lahad. These are the families of the Zorathites.* Reaiah the son of Shobal begat Jahath, and Jahath begat Ahumai and Lahad. These are the families of the Zorathites.
- 3 *And these were of the father of Etam: Jezreel, and Ishma, and Idbash: and the name of their sister was Hazelelponi:* These were the sons of Etam's father: Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash. The name of their sister was Hazelelponi;
- 4 *And Penuel the father of Gedor, and Ezer the father of Hushah. These are the sons of Hur, the firstborn of Ephratah, the father of Bethlehem.* Penuel the father of Gedor, and Ezer the father of Hushah. These are the sons of Hur the firstborn of Ephratah, the father of Bethlehem.
- 5 *And Ashur the father of Tekoa had two wives, Helah and Naarah.* Ashhur the father of Tekoa had two wives, Helah and Naarah.
- 6 *And Naarah bare him Ahuzam, and Hephher, and Temeni, and Haahashtari. These were the sons of Naarah.* Naarah bore him Ahuzzam, Hephher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. These were the sons of Naarah.
- 7 *And the sons of Helah were, Zereth, and Jezoar, and Ethnan.* The sons of Helah: Zereth, Izhar, and Ethnan.
- 8 *And Koz begat Anub, and Zobebah, and the families of Aharhel the son of Harum.* Koz begat Anub, Zobebah, and the families of Aharhel the son of Harum.
- 9 *And Jabez was more honourable than his brethren: and his mother called his name Jabez, saying, Because I bare him with sorrow.* Jabez was more honorable than his brothers. His mother had named him Jabez, saying, "I bore him in pain."
- 10 *And Jabez called on the God of Israel, saying, Oh that thou wouldest bless me indeed, and enlarge my coast, and that thine hand might be with me, and that thou wouldest keep me from evil, that it may not grieve me! And God granted him that which he requested.* Jabez called on the God of Israel, saying, "Oh that you would bless me and enlarge my territory, and that your hand would be with me, and that you would keep me from harm so that it might not bring me pain!" And God granted what He requested.

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| 11 | <i>And Chelub the brother of Shuah begat Mehir, which was the father of Eshton.</i> | Chelub the brother of Shuhah begat Mehir, who was the father of Eshton. |
| 12 | <i>And Eshton begat Bethrapha, and Paseah, and Tehinnah the father of Irnahash. These are the men of Rechah.</i> | Eshton begat Beth-rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah the father of Ir-nahash. These are the men of Recah. |
| 13 | <i>And the sons of Kenaz; Othniel, and Seraiah: and the sons of Othniel; Hathath.</i> | The sons of Kenaz: Othniel and Seraiah. The son of Othniel: Hathath. |
| 14 | <i>And Meonothai begat Ophrah: and Seraiah begat Joab, the father of the valley of Charashim; for they were craftsmen.</i> | Meonothai begat Ophrah. Seraiah begat Joab the father of Ge-harashim, for they were craftsmen. |
| 15 | <i>And the sons of Caleb the son of Jephunneh; Iru, Elah, and Naam: and the sons of Elah, even Kenaz.</i> | The sons of Caleb the son of Jephunneh: Iru, Elah, and Naam. The son of Elah: Kenaz. |
| 16 | <i>And the sons of Jehaleleel; Ziph, and Ziphah, Tiria, and Asareel.</i> | The sons of Jehallelel: Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel. |
| 17 | <i>And the sons of Ezra were, Jether, and Mered, and Ephher, and Jalon: and she bare Miriam, and Shammai, and Ishbah the father of Eshtemoa.</i> | The sons of Ezra: Jether, Mered, Ephher, and Jalon. She conceived and bore Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah the father of Eshtemoa. |
| 18 | <i>And his wife Jehudijah bare Jered the father of Gedor, and Heber the father of Socho, and Jekuthiel the father of Zanoah. And these are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of Pharaoh, which Mered took.</i> | his wife Jehudijah bore Jered the father of Gedor, Heber the father of Socho, and Jekuthiel the father of Zanoah. These are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of Pharaoh, whom Mered took. |
| 19 | <i>And the sons of his wife Hodiah the sister of Naham, the father of Keilah the Garmite, and Eshtemoa the Maachathite.</i> | The sons of the wife of Hodiah, the sister of Naham, were the father of Keilah the Garmite and Eshtemoa the Maacathite. |

- 20 *And the sons of Shimon were, Amnon, and Rinnah, Benhanan, and Tilon. And the sons of Ishi were, Zoheth, and Benzoheth.* The sons of Shimon: Amnon, Rinnah, Ben-hanan, and Tilon. The sons of Ishi: Zoheth and Ben-zoheth.
- 21 *The sons of Shelah the son of Judah were, Er the father of Lecah, and Laadah the father of Mareshah, and the families of the house of them that wrought fine linen, of the house of Ashbea,* The sons of Shelah the son of Judah: Er the father of Lecah, Laadah the father of Mareshah, and the families of the house of linen workers at Beth-ashbea;
- 22 *And Jokim, and the men of Chozeba, and Joash, and Saraph, who had the dominion in Moab, and Jashubilehem. And these are ancient things.* Jokim, the men of Cozeba, Joash, and Saraph, who ruled in Moab and Jashubilehem (now these are ancient records).
- 23 *These were the potters, and those that dwelt among plants and hedges: there they dwelt with the king for his work.* These were the potters, and those that dwelt among plants and hedges. They lived there with the king in his service.
- 24 *The sons of Simeon were, Nemuel, and Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul:* The sons of Simeon: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul;
- 25 *Shallum his son, Mibsam his son, Mishma his son.* Shallum his son, Mibsam his son, Mishma his son.
- 26 *And the sons of Mishma; Hamuel his son, Zaccur his son, Shimei his son.* The son of Mishma: Hamuel his son, Zaccur his son, Shimei his son.
- 27 *And Shimei had sixteen sons and six daughters; but his brethren had not many children, neither did all their family multiply, like to the children of Judah.* Shimei had sixteen sons and six daughters; but his brothers did not have many children, nor did all their family multiply like the sons of Judah.
- 28 *And they dwelt at Beersheba, and Moladah, and Hazarshual,* They lived at Beersheba, Moladah, Hazar-shual,
- 29 *And at Bilhah, and at Ezem, and at Tolad,* Bilhah, Ezem, Tolad,
- 30 *And at Bethuel, and at Hormah, and at Ziklag,* Bethuel, Hormah, Ziklag,

- 31 *And at Bethmarcaboth, and Hazarsusim, and at Bethbirei, and at Shaaraim. These were their cities unto the reign of David.* Beth-marcaboth, Hazar-susim, Beth-biri, and Shaaraim. These were their cities until the reign of David.
- 32 *And their villages were, Etam, and Ain, Rimmon, and Tochen, and Ashan, five cities:* Their villages were Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Tochen, and Ashan — five cities —
- 33 *And all their villages that were round about the same cities, unto Baal. These were their habitations, and their genealogy.* Along with all the villages around these cities as far as Baal. These were their settlements. They kept a genealogical record.
- 34 *And Meshobab, and Jamlech, and Joshah the son of Amaziah,* Meshobab, Jamlech, Joshah the son of Amaziah,
- 35 *And Joel, and Jehu the son of Josibiah, the son of Seraiah, the son of Asiel,* Joel, Jehu the son of Joshibiah, son of Seraiah, son of Asiel,
- 36 *And Elioenai, and Jaakobah, and Jeshohaiah, and Asaiah, and Adiel, and Jesimiel, and Benaiah,* Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, Benaiah,
- 37 *And Ziza the son of Shiphi, the son of Allon, the son of Jedaiah, the son of Shimri, the son of Shemaiah;* Ziza the son of Shiphi, son of Allon, son of Jedaiah, son of Shimri, son of Shemaiah —
- 38 *These mentioned by their names were princes in their families: and their families increased greatly.* These mentioned by name were leaders in their families. Their families increased greatly.
- 39 *And they went to the entrance of Gedor, even unto the east side of the valley, to seek pasture for their flocks.* They went to the entrance of Gedor as far as the eastern side of the valley to seek pasture for their flocks.
- 40 *And they found fat pasture and good, and the land was wide, and quiet, and peaceable; for they of Ham had dwelt there of old.* They found rich, good pasture, and the land was broad, quiet, and peaceful, for the former inhabitants there belonged to Ham.

- 41 *And these written by name came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and smote their tents, and the habitations that were found there, and destroyed them utterly unto this day, and dwelt in their rooms: because there was pasture there for their flocks.* These, recorded by name, came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah and smote their tents and the habitations that were found there, and devoted them to destruction to this day, and settled in their place, because there was pasture there for their flocks.
- 42 *And some of them, even of the sons of Simeon, five hundred men, went to mount Seir, having for their captains Pelatiah, and Neariah, and Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi.* Some of them, five hundred men of the tribe of Simeon, went to Mount Seir with Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel — sons of Ishi — as their leaders.
- 43 *And they smote the rest of the Amalekites that were escaped, and dwelt there unto this day.* They defeated the remaining Amalekites who had escaped, and have lived there to this day.

Words in this chapter:

Ezra (EZ-rah) — A priest and scribe who led a group of exiles back from Babylon — restored the Law among the returned community; his name means 'help.'

Judah (JOO-dah) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Miriam (MEER-ee-am) — Moses and Aaron's older sister — led the women in song after the Red Sea crossing; later struck with leprosy for challenging Moses's authority.

Pharez (FAIR-ez) — Twin son of Judah and Tamar — ancestor of King David and of Jesus; his name means 'breach' because he broke out first from the womb unexpectedly.

Simeon (SIM-ee-on) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Bethlehem (BETH-leh-hem) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Moab (MO-ab) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 46:12

v4 — 1 Chr 2:50; 1 Chr 4:18

v5 — 1 Chr 2:24

v9 — 1 Sam 4:21; Gen 35:18; Gen 3:16

v10 — Matt 7:7-11; Ps 116:1-4; Prov 10:22; Jer 33:3; Isa 41:10

v13 — Josh 15:17
v21 — Gen 38:5
v24 — Gen 46:10
v40 — Judg 18:7-10
v43 — 1 Sam 30:17

Chapter 5

The genealogy records the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh east of the Jordan, noting their victories in war and their later exile by Assyria for unfaithfulness.

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| 1 | <i>Now the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel, (for he was the firstborn; but, forasmuch as he defiled his father's bed, his birthright was given unto the sons of Joseph the son of Israel: and the genealogy is not to be reckoned after the birthright.</i> | The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel — he was the firstborn, but because he defiled his father's bed, his birthright was given to the sons of Joseph the son of Israel, so that he is not enrolled in the genealogy according to the birthright. |
| 2 | <i>For Judah prevailed above his brethren, and of him came the chief ruler; but the birthright was Joseph's:)</i> | For Judah prevailed among his brothers, and from him came the prince; but the birthright belonged to Joseph — |
| 3 | <i>The sons, I say, of Reuben the firstborn of Israel were, Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.</i> | The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi. |
| 4 | <i>The sons of Joel; Shemaiah his son, Gog his son, Shimei his son,</i> | The sons of Joel: Shemaiah his son, Gog his son, Shimei his son, |
| 5 | <i>Micah his son, Reaia his son, Baal his son,</i> | Micah his son, Reaiah his son, Baal his son, |
| 6 | <i>Beerah his son, whom Tilgathpilneser king of Assyria carried away captive: he was prince of the Reubenites.</i> | Beerah his son, whom Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria carried into exile; he was a chief of the Reubenites. |
| 7 | <i>And his brethren by their families, when the genealogy of their generations was reckoned, were the chief, Jeiel, and Zechariah,</i> | His kinsmen by their clans, when their genealogy was recorded by generations: Jeiel the chief, and Zechariah, |

- 8 *And Bela the son of Azaz, the son of Shema, the son of Joel, who dwelt in Aroer, even unto Nebo and Baalmeon:* Bela the son of Azaz, son of Shema, son of Joel, who lived in Aroer, as far as Nebo and Baal-meon.
- 9 *And eastward he inhabited unto the entering in of the wilderness from the river Euphrates: because their cattle were multiplied in the land of Gilead.* He also lived to the east as far as the beginning of the wilderness toward the Euphrates, because their livestock had multiplied in the land of Gilead.
- 10 *And in the days of Saul they made war with the Hagarites, who fell by their hand: and they dwelt in their tents throughout all the east land of Gilead.* In the days of Saul they waged war against the Hagrites, who fell by their hand. They lived in their tents throughout all the region east of Gilead.
- 11 *And the children of Gad dwelt over against them, in the land of Bashan unto Salchah:* The sons of Gad lived opposite them in the land of Bashan as far as Salecah:
- 12 *Joel the chief, and Shapham the next, and Jaanai, and Shaphat in Bashan.* Joel the chief, Shapham the second, Janai, and Shaphat in Bashan.
- 13 *And their brethren of the house of their fathers were, Michael, and Meshullam, and Sheba, and Jorai, and Jachan, and Zia, and Heber, seven.* Their kinsmen of their fathers' houses: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber — seven.
- 14 *These are the children of Abihail the son of Huri, the son of Jaroah, the son of Gilead, the son of Michael, the son of Jeshishai, the son of Jahdo, the son of Buz;* These were the sons of Abihail the son of Huri, son of Jaroah, son of Gilead, son of Michael, son of Jeshishai, son of Jahdo, son of Buz;
- 15 *Ahi the son of Abdiel, the son of Guni, chief of the house of their fathers.* Ahi the son of Abdiel, son of Guni — chief of their fathers' households.
- 16 *And they dwelt in Gilead in Bashan, and in her towns, and in all the suburbs of Sharon, upon their borders.* They lived in Gilead, in Bashan and its towns, and in all the pasturelands of Sharon to their limits.

- 17 *All these were reckoned by genealogies in the days of Jotham king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam king of Israel.* All of these were enrolled by genealogies in the days of Jotham king of Judah and in the days of Jeroboam king of Israel.
- 18 *The sons of Reuben, and the Gadites, and half the tribe of Manasseh, of valiant men, men able to bear buckler and sword, and to shoot with bow, and skilful in war, were four and forty thousand seven hundred and threescore, that went out to the war.* The sons of Reuben, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had valiant men who carried shield and sword, drew the bow, and were skillful in war: forty-four thousand seven hundred sixty, ready for battle.
- 19 *And they made war with the Hagarites, with Jetur, and Nephish, and Nodab.* They waged war against the Hagrites, Jetur, Naphish, and Nodab.
- 20 *And they were helped against them, and the Hagarites were delivered into their hand, and all that were with them: for they cried to God in the battle, and he was intreated of them; because they put their trust in him.* They were helped against them, and the Hagrites were given into their hands, and all who were with them, for they cried to God in the battle. He answered their prayer because they trusted in Him.
- 21 *And they took away their cattle; of their camels fifty thousand, and of sheep two hundred and fifty thousand, and of asses two thousand; and of men an hundred thousand.* They took captive their livestock: fifty thousand camels, two hundred fifty thousand sheep, two thousand donkeys, and a hundred thousand human lives.
- 22 *For there fell down many slain, because the war was of God. And they dwelt in their steads until the captivity.* For many fell slain, because the war was from God. And they lived in their land until the exile.
- 23 *And the children of the half tribe of Manasseh dwelt in the land: they increased from Bashan unto Baalhermon and Senir, and unto mount Hermon.* The members of the half-tribe of Manasseh lived in the land. They were very numerous from Bashan to Baal-hermon, Senir, and Mount Hermon.

- 24 *And these were the heads of the house of their fathers, even Ephraim, and Ishi, and Eliel, and Azriel, and Jeremiah, and Hodaviah, and Jahdiel, mighty men of valour, famous men, and heads of the house of their fathers.* These were the heads of their fathers' houses: Ephraim, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel, mighty warriors, famous men, heads of their fathers' houses.
- 25 *And they transgressed against the God of their fathers, and went a whoring after the gods of the people of the land, whom God destroyed before them.* But they broke faith with the God of their fathers and went a whoring after the gods of the peoples of the land, whom God had destroyed before them.
- 26 *And the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria, and the spirit of Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria, and he carried them away, even the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh, and brought them unto Halah, and Habor, and Hara, and to the river Gozan, unto this day.* So the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria and the spirit of Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria. He carried them into exile — the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh — and brought them to Halah, Habor, Hara, and the river Gozan, where they are to this day.

Words in this chapter:

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Bashan (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 35:22; Gen 48:15-22; Gen 29:32; Gen 49:3-4
- v2 — Matt 2:6; Mic 5:2; Heb 7:14; Gen 49:8-10; Ps 60:7
- v3 — Gen 46:9; Ex 6:14; Num 26:5-9
- v9 — Josh 22:8-9
- v11 — Josh 13:11
- v16 — 1 Chr 27:29; Isa 35:2; Song 2:1
- v17 — 2 Kgs 15:32; 2 Kgs 14:28; 2 Kgs 14:16; 2 Kgs 15:5
- v19 — 1 Chr 1:31; Gen 25:15
- v20 — Ps 22:4-5; Ps 9:10; 2 Chr 18:31; Ps 20:7-8; Josh 10:14
- v21 — Num 31:35; Rev 18:13
- v22 — 2 Chr 32:8; Josh 23:10; Rom 8:31; 2 Kgs 15:29
- v26 — 2 Kgs 15:19; 2 Kgs 17:6; 2 Kgs 15:29; 2 Kgs 18:11; 2 Chr 33:11

Chapter 6

The genealogy traces the line of Levi through his three sons, lists the descendants of Aaron the high priest, records the Levitical singers appointed by David, and assigns the Levitical cities.

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| 1 | <i>The sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.</i> | The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. |
| 2 | <i>And the sons of Kohath; Amram, Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel.</i> | The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. |
| 3 | <i>And the children of Amram; Aaron, and Moses, and Miriam. The sons also of Aaron; Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.</i> | The children of Amram: Aaron, Moses, and Miriam. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. |
| 4 | <i>Eleazar begat Phinehas, Phinehas begat Abishua,</i> | Eleazar begat Phinehas, Phinehas begat Abishua, |
| 5 | <i>And Abishua begat Bukki, and Bukki begat Uzzi,</i> | Abishua begat Bukki, Bukki begat Uzzi, |
| 6 | <i>And Uzzi begat Zerahiah, and Zerahiah begat Meraioth,</i> | Uzzi begat Zerahiah, Zerahiah begat Meraioth, |
| 7 | <i>Meraioth begat Amariah, and Amariah begat Ahitub,</i> | Meraioth begat Amariah, Amariah begat Ahitub, |

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| <p>8 <i>And Ahitub begat Zadok, and Zadok begat Ahimaaz,</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Ahimaaz begat Azariah, and Azariah begat Johanan,</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Johanan begat Azariah, (he it is that executed the priest's office in the temple that Solomon built in Jerusalem:)</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Azariah begat Amariah, and Amariah begat Ahitub,</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Ahitub begat Zadok, and Zadok begat Shallum,</i></p> <p>13 <i>And Shallum begat Hilkiah, and Hilkiah begat Azariah,</i></p> <p>14 <i>And Azariah begat Seraiah, and Seraiah begat Jehozadak,</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Jehozadak went into captivity, when the LORD carried away Judah and Jerusalem by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar.</i></p> <p>16 <i>The sons of Levi; Gershom, Kohath, and Merari.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And these be the names of the sons of Gershom; Libni, and Shimei.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the sons of Kohath were, Amram, and Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The sons of Merari; Mahli, and Mushi. And these are the families of the Levites according to their fathers.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Of Gershom; Libni his son, Jahath his son, Zimmah his son,</i></p> <p>21 <i>Joah his son, Iddo his son, Zerah his son, Jeaterai his son.</i></p> | <p>Ahitub begat Zadok, Zadok begat Ahimaaz,</p> <p>Ahimaaz begat Azariah, Azariah begat Johanan,</p> <p>Johanan begat Azariah — it was he who served as priest in the temple that Solomon built in Jerusalem —</p> <p>Azariah begat Amariah, Amariah begat Ahitub,</p> <p>Ahitub begat Zadok, Zadok begat Shallum,</p> <p>Shallum begat Hilkiah, Hilkiah begat Azariah,</p> <p>Azariah begat Seraiah, Seraiah begat Jehozadak;</p> <p>Jehozadak went into exile when the LORD carried away Judah and Jerusalem by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar.</p> <p>The sons of Levi: Gershom, Kohath, and Merari.</p> <p>These are the names of the sons of Gershom: Libni and Shimei.</p> <p>The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.</p> <p>The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to their fathers.</p> <p>Of Gershom: Libni His son, Jahath His son, Zimmah His son,</p> <p>Joah His son, Iddo His son, Zerah His son, Jeatherai His son.</p> |
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- 22 *The sons of Kohath; Amminadab his son, Korah his son, Assir his son,* The sons of Kohath: Amminadab His son, Korah His son, Assir His son,
- 23 *Elkanah his son, and Ebiasaph his son, and Assir his son,* Elkanah His son, Ebiasaph His son, Assir His son,
- 24 *Tahath his son, Uriel his son, Uziah his son, and Shaul his son.* Tahath his son, Uriel his son, Uziah his son, and Shaul his son.
- 25 *And the sons of Elkanah; Amasai, and Ahimoth.* The sons of Elkanah: Amasai and Ahimoth.
- 26 *As for Elkanah: the sons of Elkanah; Zophai his son, and Nahath his son,* As for Elkanah: his son Zophai, his son Nahath,
- 27 *Eliab his son, Jeroham his son, Elkanah his son.* His son Eliab, his son Jeroham, his son Elkanah.
- 28 *And the sons of Samuel; the firstborn Vashni, and Abiah.* The sons of Samuel: the firstborn Vashni, and Abiah.
- 29 *The sons of Merari; Mahli, Libni his son, Shimei his son, Uzza his son,* The sons of Merari: Mahli, Libni his son, Shimei his son, Uzza his son,
- 30 *Shimea his son, Haggiah his son, Asaiah his son.* Shimea his son, Haggiah his son, Asaiah his son.
- 31 *And these are they whom David set over the service of song in the house of the LORD, after that the ark had rest.* These are the men whom David put in charge of the service of song in the house of the LORD after the ark came to rest.
- 32 *And they ministered before the dwelling place of the tabernacle of the congregation with singing, until Solomon had built the house of the LORD in Jerusalem: and then they waited on their office according to their order.* They ministered with song before the tent of meeting until Solomon built the house of the LORD in Jerusalem. They performed their service in the proper order.
- 33 *And these are they that waited with their children. Of the sons of the Kohathites: Heman a singer, the son of Joel, the son of Shemuel,* These are those who served with their sons. Of the sons of the Kohathites: Heman the singer, the son of Joel, the son of Samuel,

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| <p>34 <i>The son of Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliel, the son of Toah,</i></p> <p>35 <i>The son of Zuph, the son of Elkanah, the son of Mahath, the son of Amasai,</i></p> <p>36 <i>The son of Elkanah, the son of Joel, the son of Azariah, the son of Zephaniah,</i></p> <p>37 <i>The son of Tahath, the son of Assir, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah,</i></p> <p>38 <i>The son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, the son of Israel.</i></p> <p>39 <i>And his brother Asaph, who stood on his right hand, even Asaph the son of Berachiah, the son of Shimea,</i></p> <p>40 <i>The son of Michael, the son of Baaseiah, the son of Malchiah,</i></p> <p>41 <i>The son of Ethni, the son of Zerah, the son of Adaiah,</i></p> <p>42 <i>The son of Ethan, the son of Zimmah, the son of Shimei,</i></p> <p>43 <i>The son of Jahath, the son of Gershon, the son of Levi.</i></p> <p>44 <i>And their brethren the sons of Merari stood on the left hand: Ethan the son of Kishi, the son of Abdi, the son of Malluch,</i></p> <p>45 <i>The son of Hashabiah, the son of Amaziah, the son of Hilkiah,</i></p> <p>46 <i>The son of Amzi, the son of Bani, the son of Shamer,</i></p> <p>47 <i>The son of Mahli, the son of Mushi, the son of Merari, the son of Levi.</i></p> | <p>The son of Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliel, the son of Toah,</p> <p>The son of Zuph, the son of Elkanah, the son of Mahath, the son of Amasai,</p> <p>The son of Elkanah, the son of Joel, the son of Azariah, the son of Zephaniah,</p> <p>The son of Tahath, the son of Assir, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah,</p> <p>The son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, the son of Israel.</p> <p>His brother Asaph, who stood at his right hand: Asaph the son of Berechiah, the son of Shimea,</p> <p>The son of Michael, the son of Baaseiah, the son of Malchijah,</p> <p>The son of Ethni, the son of Zerah, the son of Adaiah,</p> <p>The son of Ethan, the son of Zimmah, the son of Shimei,</p> <p>The son of Jahath, the son of Gershon, the son of Levi.</p> <p>Their brothers the sons of Merari stood at the left hand: Ethan the son of Kishi, the son of Abdi, the son of Malluch,</p> <p>The son of Hashabiah, the son of Amaziah, the son of Hilkiah,</p> <p>The son of Amzi, the son of Bani, the son of Shemer,</p> <p>The son of Mahli, the son of Mushi, the son of Merari, the son of Levi.</p> |
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- 48 *Their brethren also the Levites were appointed unto all manner of service of the tabernacle of the house of God.* Their brothers the Levites were appointed to all the other service of the tent of the house of God.
- 49 *But Aaron and his sons offered upon the altar of the burnt offering, and on the altar of incense, and were appointed for all the work of the place most holy, and to make an atonement for Israel, according to all that Moses the servant of God had commanded.* But Aaron and his sons made offerings on the altar of burnt offering and on the altar of incense — all the work of the most holy place — to make atonement for Israel, according to all that Moses the servant of God had commanded.
- 50 *And these are the sons of Aaron; Eleazar his son, Phinehas his son, Abishua his son,* These are the sons of Aaron: Eleazar his son, Phinehas his son, Abishua his son,
- 51 *Bukki his son, Uzzi his son, Zerahiah his son,* Bukki his son, Uzzi his son, Zerahiah his son,
- 52 *Meraioth his son, Amariah his son, Ahitub his son,* Meraioth his son, Amariah his son, Ahitub his son,
- 53 *Zadok his son, Ahimaaz his son.* Zadok his son, Ahimaaz his son.
- 54 *Now these are their dwelling places throughout their castles in their coasts, of the sons of Aaron, of the families of the Kohathites: for theirs was the lot.* These are their dwelling places according to their settlements in their territory: to the sons of Aaron of the Kohathite clan, for theirs was the first lot —
- 55 *And they gave them Hebron in the land of Judah, and the suburbs thereof round about it.* They were given Hebron in the land of Judah and its surrounding pasturelands.
- 56 *But the fields of the city, and the villages thereof, they gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh.* But the fields of the city and its villages they gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh.
- 57 *And to the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of Judah, namely, Hebron, the city of refuge, and Libnah with her suburbs, and Jattir, and Eshtemoa, with their suburbs,* To the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of refuge: Hebron, Libnah with its pasturelands, Jattir, Eshtemoa with its pasturelands,

- 58 *And Hilen with her suburbs, Debir with her suburbs,* Hilen with its pasturelands, Debir with its pasturelands,
- 59 *And Ashan with her suburbs, and Bethshemesh with her suburbs:* Ashan with its pasturelands, and Beth-shemesh with its pasturelands;
- 60 *And out of the tribe of Benjamin; Geba with her suburbs, and Alemeth with her suburbs, and Anathoth with her suburbs. All their cities throughout their families were thirteen cities.* From the tribe of Benjamin: Geba with its pasturelands, Alemeth with its pasturelands, and Anathoth with its pasturelands. All their cities throughout their clans were thirteen cities.
- 61 *And unto the sons of Kohath, which were left of the family of that tribe, were cities given out of the half tribe, namely, out of the half tribe of Manasseh, by lot, ten cities.* To the rest of the sons of Kohath were given by lot ten cities from the clan of the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 62 *And to the sons of Gershom throughout their families out of the tribe of Issachar, and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.* To the sons of Gershom, throughout their clans, were given thirteen cities from the tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and Manasseh in Bashan.
- 63 *Unto the sons of Merari were given by lot, throughout their families, out of the tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.* To the sons of Merari were given by lot twelve cities from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and Zebulun.
- 64 *And the children of Israel gave to the Levites these cities with their suburbs.* So the people of Israel gave the Levites these cities with their pasturelands.
- 65 *And they gave by lot out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, and out of the tribe of the children of Benjamin, these cities, which are called by their names.* They gave by lot from the tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin the cities that are mentioned by name.

- 66 *And the residue of the families of the sons of Kohath had cities of their coasts out of the tribe of Ephraim.* Some of the clans of the sons of Kohath had cities from the tribe of Ephraim as their territory.
- 67 *And they gave unto them, of the cities of refuge, Shechem in mount Ephraim with her suburbs; they gave also Gezer with her suburbs,* They were given the cities of refuge: Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim with its pasturelands, Gezer with its pasturelands,
- 68 *And Jokmeam with her suburbs, and Bethhoron with her suburbs,* Jokmeam with its pasturelands, Beth-horon with its pasturelands,
- 69 *And Aijalon with her suburbs, and Gathrimmon with her suburbs:* Aijalon with its pasturelands, and Gath-rimmon with its pasturelands;
- 70 *And out of the half tribe of Manasseh; Aner with her suburbs, and Bileam with her suburbs, for the family of the remnant of the sons of Kohath.* From the half-tribe of Manasseh: Aner with its pasturelands and Bileam with its pasturelands, for the rest of the clan of the sons of Kohath.
- 71 *Unto the sons of Gershom were given out of the family of the half tribe of Manasseh, Golan in Bashan with her suburbs, and Ashtaroth with her suburbs:* To the sons of Gershom were given from the clan of the half-tribe of Manasseh: Golan in Bashan with its pasturelands and Ashtaroth with its pasturelands;
- 72 *And out of the tribe of Issachar; Kedesh with her suburbs, Daberath with her suburbs,* From the tribe of Issachar: Kedesh with its pasturelands, Daberath with its pasturelands,
- 73 *And Ramoth with her suburbs, and Anem with her suburbs:* Ramoth with its pasturelands, and Anem with its pasturelands;
- 74 *And out of the tribe of Asher; Mashal with her suburbs, and Abdon with her suburbs,* From the tribe of Asher: Mashal with its pasturelands, Abdon with its pasturelands,
- 75 *And Hukok with her suburbs, and Rehob with her suburbs:* Hukok with its pasturelands, and Rehob with its pasturelands;
- 76 *And out of the tribe of Naphtali; Kedesh in Galilee with her suburbs, and Hammon with her suburbs, and Kirjathaim with her suburbs.* From the tribe of Naphtali: Kedesh in Galilee with its pasturelands, Hammon with its pasturelands, and Kiriathaim with its pasturelands.

77	<i>Unto the rest of the children of Merari were given out of the tribe of Zebulun, Rimmon with her suburbs, Tabor with her suburbs:</i>	To the rest of the sons of Merari were given from the tribe of Zebulun: Rimmono with its pasturelands, Tabor with its pasturelands;
78	<i>And on the other side Jordan by Jericho, on the east side of Jordan, were given them out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer in the wilderness with her suburbs, and Jahzah with her suburbs,</i>	Beyond the Jordan at Jericho, on the east side of the Jordan, from the tribe of Reuben: Bezer in the wilderness with its pasturelands, Jahzah with its pasturelands,
79	<i>Kedemoth also with her suburbs, and Mephaath with her suburbs:</i>	Kedemoth with its pasturelands, and Mephaath with its pasturelands;
80	<i>And out of the tribe of Gad; Ramoth in Gilead with her suburbs, and Mahanaim with her suburbs,</i>	From the tribe of Gad: Ramoth in Gilead with its pasturelands, Mahanaim with its pasturelands,
81	<i>And Heshbon with her suburbs, and Jazer with her suburbs.</i>	Heshbon with its pasturelands, and Jazer with its pasturelands.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 46:11; Ex 6:16; Num 26:57

v8 — 2 Sam 15:27; 2 Sam 8:17

v14 — 2 Kgs 25:18

v16 — Ex 6:16

v19 — 1 Chr 23:21

v27 — 1 Sam 1:1

v31 — 2 Sam 6:17

v49 — Lev 4:20

v71 — Josh 21:27

Chapter 7

The genealogy records the descendants of Issachar, Benjamin, Naphtali, Manasseh, Ephraim, and Asher, noting their mighty warriors and their numbers.

- 1 *Now the sons of Issachar were, Tola, and Puah, Jashub, and Shimron, four.* The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron — four.
- 2 *And the sons of Tola; Uzzi, and Rephaiah, and Jeriel, and Jahmai, and Jibsam, and Shemuel, heads of their father's house, to wit, of Tola: they were valiant men of might in their generations; whose number was in the days of David two and twenty thousand and six hundred.* The sons of Tola: Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Shemuel, heads of their fathers' houses. The descendants of Tola were mighty warriors in their generations; their number in the days of David was twenty-two thousand six hundred.
- 3 *And the sons of Uzzi; Izrahiah: and the sons of Izrahiah; Michael, and Obadiah, and Joel, Ishiah, five: all of them chief men.* The son of Uzzi: Izrahiah. The sons of Izrahiah: Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah — five, all of them chief men.
- 4 *And with them, by their generations, after the house of their fathers, were bands of soldiers for war, six and thirty thousand men: for they had many wives and sons.* Along with them, by their generations, according to their fathers' houses, were bands of warriors for battle, thirty-six thousand, for they had many wives and sons.
- 5 *And their brethren among all the families of Issachar were valiant men of might, reckoned in all by their genealogies fourscore and seven thousand.* Their brothers throughout all the clans of Issachar were mighty warriors, enrolled by genealogy in all — eighty-seven thousand.

- 6 *The sons of Benjamin; Bela, and Becher, and Jediel, three.* The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher, and Jediel — three.
- 7 *And the sons of Bela; Ezbon, and Uzzi, and Uzziel, and Jerimoth, and Iri, five; heads of the house of their fathers, mighty men of valour; and were reckoned by their genealogies twenty and two thousand and thirty and four.* The sons of Bela: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, and Iri — five heads of fathers' houses, mighty warriors. They were enrolled by genealogy: twenty-two thousand thirty-four.
- 8 *And the sons of Becher; Zemira, and Joash, and Eliezer, and Elioenai, and Omri, and Jerimoth, and Abiah, and Anathoth, and Alameth. All these are the sons of Becher.* The sons of Becher: Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, and Alemeth. All these were the sons of Becher.
- 9 *And the number of them, after their genealogy by their generations, heads of the house of their fathers, mighty men of valour, was twenty thousand and two hundred.* Their enrollment by genealogy, according to their generations, as heads of their fathers' houses, mighty warriors: twenty thousand two hundred.
- 10 *The sons also of Jediel; Bilhan: and the sons of Bilhan; Jeush, and Benjamin, and Ehud, and Chenaanah, and Zethan, and Tharshish, and Ahishahar.* The son of Jediel: Bilhan. The sons of Bilhan: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Chenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, and Ahishahar.
- 11 *All these the sons of Jediel, by the heads of their fathers, mighty men of valour, were seventeen thousand and two hundred soldiers, fit to go out for war and battle.* All these were sons of Jediel, heads of their fathers' houses, mighty warriors — seventeen thousand two hundred men fit to go to war.
- 12 *Shuppm also, and Huppm, the children of Ir, and Hushim, the sons of Aher.* Shuppm and Huppm were the sons of Ir; Hushim was the son of Aher.
- 13 *The sons of Naphtali; Jahziel, and Guni, and Jezer, and Shallum, the sons of Bilhah.* The sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer, and Shallum, the sons of Bilhah.

- 14 *The sons of Manasseh; Ashriel, whom she bare: (but his concubine the Aramitess bare Machir the father of Gilead:* The sons of Manasseh: Asriel, whom his Aramean concubine bore; she bore Machir the father of Gilead.
- 15 *And Machir took to wife the sister of Huppim and Shuppim, whose sister's name was Maachah;) and the name of the second was Zelophehad: and Zelophehad had daughters.* Machir took a wife for Huppim and for Shuppim. The name of his sister was Maacah. The name of the second was Zelophehad, and Zelophehad had daughters.
- 16 *And Maachah the wife of Machir bare a son, and she called his name Peresh; and the name of his brother was Sheresh; and his sons were Ulam and Rakem.* Maacah the wife of Machir bore a son. She named him Peresh. The name of his brother was Sheresh. His sons were Ulam and Rakem.
- 17 *And the sons of Ulam; Bedan. These were the sons of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh.* The son of Ulam: Bedan. These were the sons of Gilead the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh.
- 18 *And his sister Hammoleketh bare Ishod, and Abiezer, and Mahalah.* His sister Hammoleketh bore Ishhod, Abiezer, and Mahlah.
- 19 *And the sons of Shemidah were, Ahian, and Shechem, and Likhi, and Aniam.* The sons of Shemida were: Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam.
- 20 *And the sons of Ephraim; Shuthelah, and Bered his son, and Tahath his son, and Eladah his son, and Tahath his son,* The sons of Ephraim: Shuthelah, and Bered his son, Tahath his son, Eleadah his son, Tahath his son,
- 21 *And Zabad his son, and Shuthelah his son, and Ezer, and Elead, whom the men of Gath that were born in that land slew, because they came down to take away their cattle.* Zabad his son, Shuthelah his son, and Ezer and Elead — whom the men of Gath who were born in that land killed, because they came down to raid their livestock.
- 22 *And Ephraim their father mourned many days, and his brethren came to comfort him.* Ephraim their father mourned for many days. His brothers came to comfort him.

- 23 *And when he went in to his wife, she conceived, and bare a son, and he called his name Beriah, because it went evil with his house.* He went in to his wife. She conceived and bore a son. And he called his name Beriah, because disaster had come upon his house.
- 24 *(And his daughter was Sherah, who built Bethhoron the nether, and the upper, and Uzzensherah.)* His daughter was Sheerah, who built both Lower and Upper Beth-horon, and Uzzen-sheerah.
- 25 *And Rephah was his son, also Resheph, and Telah his son, and Tahan his son,* Rephah was his son, and Resheph his son, and Telah his son, and Tahan his son,
- 26 *Laadan his son, Ammihud his son, Elishama his son,* Ladan his son, Ammihud his son, Elishama his son,
- 27 *Non his son, Jehoshuah his son.* Nun his son, Joshua his son.
- 28 *And their possessions and habitations were, Bethel and the towns thereof, and eastward Naaran, and westward Gezer, with the towns thereof; Shechem also and the towns thereof, unto Azzah and the towns thereof;* Their possessions and settlements were Bethel and its towns, Naaran to the east, Gezer and its towns to the west, Shechem and its towns, and Ayyah and its towns;
- 29 *And by the borders of the children of Manasseh, Bethshean and her towns, Taanach and her towns, Megiddo and her towns, Dor and her towns. In these dwelt the children of Joseph the son of Israel.* Along the borders of Manasseh: Beth-shean and its towns, Taanach and its towns, Megiddo and its towns, Dor and its towns. In these lived the sons of Joseph the son of Israel.
- 30 *The sons of Asher; Imnah, and Isuah, and Ishuai, and Beriah, and Serah their sister.* The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, and Beriah, and Serah their sister.
- 31 *And the sons of Beriah; Heber, and Malchiel, who is the father of Birzavith.* The sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel, who was the father of Birzaith.
- 32 *And Heber begat Japhlet, and Shomer, and Hotham, and Shua their sister.* Heber begat Japhlet, Shomer, Hotham, and Shua their sister.

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| 33 | <i>And the sons of Japhlet; Pasach, and Bimhal, and Ashvath. These are the children of Japhlet.</i> | The sons of Japhlet: Pasach, Bimhal, and Ashvath. These are the sons of Japhlet. |
| 34 | <i>And the sons of Shamer; Ahi, and Rohgah, Jehubbah, and Aram.</i> | The sons of Shemer: Ahi, Rohgah, Jehubbah, and Aram. |
| 35 | <i>And the sons of his brother Helem; Zophah, and Imna, and Shelesh, and Amal.</i> | The sons of his brother Helem: Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, and Amal. |
| 36 | <i>The sons of Zophah; Suah, and Harnepher, and Shual, and Beri, and Imrah,</i> | The sons of Zophah: Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, |
| 37 | <i>Bezer, and Hod, and Shamma, and Shilshah, and Ithran, and Beera.</i> | Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, and Beera. |
| 38 | <i>And the sons of Jether; Jephunneh, and Pispah, and Ara.</i> | The sons of Jether: Jephunneh, Pispah, and Ara. |
| 39 | <i>And the sons of Ulla; Arah, and Haniel, and Rezia.</i> | The sons of Ulla: Arah, Haniel, and Rezia. |
| 40 | <i>All these were the children of Asher, heads of their father's house, choice and mighty men of valour, chief of the princes. And the number throughout the genealogy of them that were apt to the war and to battle was twenty and six thousand men.</i> | All of these were the sons of Asher, heads of fathers' houses, selected, mighty warriors, chief among the princes. Their enrollment by genealogy for service in war: twenty-six thousand men. |

Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Megiddo (*meh-GID-oh*) — A strategic city at the pass through the Carmel range — site of many decisive battles; in Revelation, Armageddon (Har-Megiddo) is the great final battlefield.

Cross-References:

- v13** — Num 26:48-49
- v24** — Josh 16:5; Josh 16:3
- v27** — Num 13:16; Deut 31:23
- v30** — Gen 46:17

Chapter 8

The genealogy traces the descendants of Benjamin in detail, including the house of Saul through Kish and Jonathan down to their later generations.

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| 1 | <i>Now Benjamin begat Bela his firstborn, Ashbel the second, and Aharah the third,</i> | Benjamin begat Bela his firstborn, Ashbel the second, Aharah the third, |
| 2 | <i>Nohah the fourth, and Rapha the fifth.</i> | Nohah the fourth, and Rapha the fifth. |
| 3 | <i>And the sons of Bela were, Addar, and Gera, and Abihud,</i> | The sons of Bela: Addar, Gera, Abihud, |
| 4 | <i>And Abishua, and Naaman, and Ahoah,</i> | Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, |
| 5 | <i>And Gera, and Shephuphan, and Huram.</i> | Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram. |
| 6 | <i>And these are the sons of Ehud: these are the heads of the fathers of the inhabitants of Geba, and they removed them to Manahath:</i> | These are the sons of Ehud — these are the heads of fathers' houses of the inhabitants of Geba, who were carried into exile to Manahath: |
| 7 | <i>And Naaman, and Ahiah, and Gera, he removed them, and begat Uzza, and Ahihud.</i> | Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera — he carried them into exile. He begat Uzza and Ahihud. |
| 8 | <i>And Shaharaim begat children in the country of Moab, after he had sent them away; Hushim and Baara were his wives.</i> | Shaharaim begat sons in the land of Moab after he had sent away his wives Hushim and Baara. |

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| <p>9 <i>And he begat of Hodesh his wife, Jobab, and Zibia, and Mesha, and Malcham,</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Jeuz, and Shachia, and Mirma. These were his sons, heads of the fathers.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And of Hushim he begat Abitub, and Elpaal.</i></p> <p>12 <i>The sons of Elpaal; Eber, and Misham, and Shamed, who built Ono, and Lod, with the towns thereof:</i></p> <p>13 <i>Beriah also, and Shema, who were heads of the fathers of the inhabitants of Aijalon, who drove away the inhabitants of Gath:</i></p> <p>14 <i>And Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth,</i></p> <p>15 <i>And Zebadiah, and Arad, and Ader,</i></p> <p>16 <i>And Michael, and Ispah, and Joha, the sons of Beriah;</i></p> <p>17 <i>And Zebadiah, and Meshullam, and Hezeki, and Heber,</i></p> <p>18 <i>Ishmerai also, and Jezliah, and Jobab, the sons of Elpaal;</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Jakim, and Zichri, and Zabdi,</i></p> <p>20 <i>And Elienai, and Zilthai, and Eliel,</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Adaiah, and Beraiah, and Shimrath, the sons of Shimhi;</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Ishpan, and Heber, and Eliel,</i></p> <p>23 <i>And Abdon, and Zichri, and Hanan,</i></p> <p>24 <i>And Hananiah, and Elam, and Antothijah,</i></p> | <p>He begat by his wife Hodesh: Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam,</p> <p>Jeuz, Sachia, and Mirmah. These were his sons, heads of fathers' houses.</p> <p>Of Hushim he begat Abitub and Elpaal.</p> <p>The sons of Elpaal: Eber, Misham, and Shemed, who built Ono and Lod with its towns;</p> <p>Beriah and Shema, who were heads of fathers' houses of the inhabitants of Aijalon, who drove away the inhabitants of Gath;</p> <p>Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth.</p> <p>Zebadiah, Arad, Eder,</p> <p>Michael, Ishpah, and Joha were sons of Beriah;</p> <p>Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber,</p> <p>Ishmerai, Jezliah, and Jobab were sons of Elpaal;</p> <p>Jakim, Zichri, Zabdi,</p> <p>Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel,</p> <p>Adaiah, Beraiah, and Shimrath were sons of Shimei;</p> <p>Ishpan, Eber, Eliel,</p> <p>Abdon, Zichri, Hanan,</p> <p>Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah,</p> |
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- 25 *And Iphedeiah, and Penuel, the sons of Shashak;* Iphdeiah, and Penuel were sons of Shashak;
- 26 *And Shamsheraï, and Shehariah, and Athaliah,* Shamsheraï, Shehariah, Athaliah,
- 27 *And Jaresiah, and Elijah, and Zichri, the sons of Jeroham.* Jareshiah, Elijah, and Zichri were sons of Jeroham.
- 28 *These were heads of the fathers, by their generations, chief men. These dwelt in Jerusalem.* These were heads of fathers' houses, by their generations, chief men. These lived in Jerusalem.
- 29 *And at Gibeon dwelt the father of Gibeon; whose wife's name was Maachah:* At Gibeon lived the father of Gibeon — his wife's name was Maacah —
- 30 *And his firstborn son Abdon, and Zur, and Kish, and Baal, and Nadab,* His firstborn son Abdon, then Zur, Kish, Baal, Nadab,
- 31 *And Gedor, and Ahio, and Zacher.* Gedor, Ahio, Zecher,
- 32 *And Mikloth begat Shimeah. And these also dwelt with their brethren in Jerusalem, over against them.* Mikloth begat Shimeah. And these also lived opposite their brothers in Jerusalem, along with their brothers.
- 33 *And Ner begat Kish, and Kish begat Saul, and Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchishua, and Abinadab, and Eshbaal.* Ner begat Kish, Kish begat Saul, Saul begat Jonathan, Malchi-shua, Abinadab, and Esh-baal.
- 34 *And the son of Jonathan was Meribbaal; and Meribbaal begat Micah.* The son of Jonathan was Merib-baal. Merib-baal begat Micah.
- 35 *And the sons of Micah were, Pithon, and Melech, and Tarea, and Ahaz.* The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz.
- 36 *And Ahaz begat Jehoaddah; and Jehoaddah begat Alemeth, and Azmaveth, and Zimri; and Zimri begat Moza,* Ahaz begat Jehoaddah, and Jehoaddah begat Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri begat Moza.
- 37 *And Moza begat Binea: Rapha was his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son:* Moza begat Binea; Raphah was his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son.

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And Azel had six sons, whose names are these, Azrikam, Bocheru, and Ishmael, and Sheariah, and Obadiah, and Hanan. All these were the sons of Azel.

Azel had six sons, and these are their names: Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. All these were the sons of Azel.
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And the sons of Eshek his brother were, Ulam his firstborn, Jehush the second, and Eliphelet the third.

The sons of Eshek his brother: Ulam his firstborn, Jeush the second, and Eliphelet the third.
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And the sons of Ulam were mighty men of valour, archers, and had many sons, and sons' sons, an hundred and fifty. All these are of the sons of Benjamin.

The sons of Ulam were mighty warriors, archers, and had many sons and grandsons — one hundred fifty. All these were Benjamin's sons.

Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Ishmael (*ISH-mee-el*) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 46:21
- v12 — Neh 7:37; Neh 6:2; Neh 11:35; Ezra 2:33
- v33 — 1 Sam 9:1

Chapter 9

The genealogy lists the first inhabitants who resettled Jerusalem after the exile — from Judah, Benjamin, the priests, and the Levites — and details the duties of the gatekeepers, with Saul's family line repeated.

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| <p>1 <i>So all Israel were reckoned by genealogies; and, behold, they were written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah, who were carried away to Babylon for their transgression.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Now the first inhabitants that dwelt in their possessions in their cities were, the Israelites, the priests, Levites, and the Nethinims.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And in Jerusalem dwelt of the children of Judah, and of the children of Benjamin, and of the children of Ephraim and Manasseh;</i></p> <p>4 <i>Uthai the son of Ammihud, the son of Omri, the son of Imri, the son of Bani, of the children of Pharez the son of Judah.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And of the Shilonites; Asaiah the firstborn, and his sons.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And of the sons of Zerah; Jeuel, and their brethren, six hundred and ninety.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And of the sons of Benjamin; Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Hodaviah, the son of Hasenuah,</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Ibneiah the son of Jeroham, and Elah the son of Uzzi, the son of Michri, and Meshullam the son of Shephatiah, the son of Reuel, the son of Ibrijah;</i></p> | <p>So all Israel was enrolled by genealogies, and these are written in the Book of the Kings of Israel. And Judah was carried away into exile in Babylon because of their unfaithfulness.</p> <p>Now the first to live again in their possessions in their cities were Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the Nethinims.</p> <p>In Jerusalem lived some of the sons of Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh:</p> <p>Uthai the son of Ammihud, son of Omri, son of Imri, son of Bani, of the sons of Perez the son of Judah;</p> <p>Of the Shilonites: Asaiah the firstborn and his sons;</p> <p>Of the sons of Zerah: Jeuel and their brothers, six hundred ninety.</p> <p>Of the sons of Benjamin: Sallu the son of Meshullam, son of Hodaviah, son of Hassenuah;</p> <p>Ibneiah the son of Jeroham; Elah the son of Uzzi, son of Michri; Meshullam the son of Shephatiah, son of Reuel, son of Ibrijah;</p> |
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- 9 *And their brethren, according to their generations, nine hundred and fifty and six. All these men were chief of the fathers in the house of their fathers.* Their brothers, according to their generations — nine hundred fifty-six. All these were heads of fathers' houses.
- 10 *And of the priests; Jedaiah, and Jehoiarib, and Jachin,* Of the priests: Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jachin,
- 11 *And Azariah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the ruler of the house of God;* Azariah the son of Hilkiah, son of Meshullam, son of Zadok, son of Meraioth, son of Ahitub — the chief officer of the house of God;
- 12 *And Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pashur, the son of Malchijah, and Maasai the son of Adiel, the son of Jahzerah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Meshillemith, the son of Immer;* Adaiah the son of Jeroham, son of Pashur, son of Malchijah. Maasai the son of Adiel, son of Jahzerah, son of Meshullam, son of Meshillemith, son of Immer;
- 13 *And their brethren, heads of the house of their fathers, a thousand and seven hundred and threescore; very able men for the work of the service of the house of God.* Their brothers, heads of their fathers' houses — one thousand seven hundred sixty, very able men for the work of the service of the house of God.
- 14 *And of the Levites; Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, of the sons of Merari;* Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, son of Azrikam, son of Hashabiah, of the sons of Merari;
- 15 *And Bakbakkar, Heresh, and Galal, and Mattaniah the son of Micah, the son of Zichri, the son of Asaph;* Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, and Mattaniah the son of Mica, son of Zichri, son of Asaph;
- 16 *And Obadiah the son of Shemaiah, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun, and Berechiah the son of Asa, the son of Elkanah, that dwelt in the villages of the Netophathites.* Obadiah the son of Shemaiah, son of Galal, son of Jeduthun. Berechiah the son of Asa, son of Elkanah, who lived in the villages of the Netophathites.

- 17 *And the porters were, Shallum, and Akkub, and Talmon, and Ahiman, and their brethren: Shallum was the chief;* The gatekeepers were Shallum, Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman. Their brothers; Shallum was the chief.
- 18 *Who hitherto waited in the king's gate eastward: they were porters in the companies of the children of Levi.* He was until then stationed at the King's Gate on the east side; they were the gatekeepers of the camp of the sons of Levi.
- 19 *And Shallum the son of Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and his brethren, of the house of his father, the Korahites, were over the work of the service, keepers of the gates of the tabernacle: and their fathers, being over the host of the LORD, were keepers of the entry.* Shallum the son of Kore, son of Ebiasaph, son of Korah. His brothers of His fathers' house, the Korahites, were in charge of the work of the service, gatekeepers of the tent, as their fathers had been in charge of the camp of the LORD, keepers of the entrance.
- 20 *And Phinehas the son of Eleazar was the ruler over them in time past, and the LORD was with him.* Phinehas the son of Eleazar was their ruler in time past. The LORD was with Him.
- 21 *And Zechariah the son of Meshelemiah was porter of the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.* Zechariah the son of Meshelemiah was gatekeeper at the entrance of the tent of meeting.
- 22 *All these which were chosen to be porters in the gates were two hundred and twelve. These were reckoned by their genealogy in their villages, whom David and Samuel the seer did ordain in their set office.* All these, who were chosen as gatekeepers in the gates, were two hundred twelve. They were enrolled by genealogy in their villages. David and Samuel the seer established them in their appointed office.
- 23 *So they and their children had the oversight of the gates of the house of the LORD, namely, the house of the tabernacle, by wards.* So they and their sons were in charge of the gates of the house of the LORD, the house of the tent, by divisions.
- 24 *In four quarters were the porters, toward the east, west, north, and south.* The gatekeepers were posted on the four sides: east, west, north, and south.

- 25 *And their brethren, which were in their villages, were to come after seven days from time to time with them.* Their brothers in their villages were to come in every seven days in turn to be with them.
- 26 *For these Levites, the four chief porters, were in their set office, and were over the chambers and treasuries of the house of God.* For the four chief gatekeepers, who were Levites, were in a position of trust, and were over the chambers and treasuries of the house of God.
- 27 *And they lodged round about the house of God, because the charge was upon them, and the opening thereof every morning pertained to them.* They lodged around the house of God, for that duty was on them. They had charge of opening it each morning.
- 28 *And certain of them had the charge of the ministering vessels, that they should bring them in and out by tale.* Some of them had charge of the ministering vessels, counting them as they were brought in and taken out.
- 29 *Some of them also were appointed to oversee the vessels, and all the instruments of the sanctuary, and the fine flour, and the wine, and the oil, and the frankincense, and the spices.* Some of them also were appointed over the furniture and all the holy vessels, and over the fine flour, the wine, the oil, the incense, and the spices.
- 30 *And some of the sons of the priests made the ointment of the spices.* Some of the sons of the priests prepared the mixing of the spices.
- 31 *And Mattithiah, one of the Levites, who was the firstborn of Shallum the Korahite, had the set office over the things that were made in the pans.* Mattithiah, one of the Levites, the firstborn of Shallum the Korahite, was in charge of the things that were baked in pans.
- 32 *And other of their brethren, of the sons of the Kohathites, were over the shewbread, to prepare it every sabbath.* Some of their brothers of the sons of the Kohathites were over the bread of the Presence, to prepare it every Sabbath.

- 33 *And these are the singers, chief of the fathers of the Levites, who remaining in the chambers were free: for they were employed in that work day and night.* These are the singers, heads of fathers' houses of the Levites, who lived in the chambers of the temple and were free from other service, for they were on duty day and night.
- 34 *These chief fathers of the Levites were chief throughout their generations; these dwelt at Jerusalem.* These were the heads of fathers' houses of the Levites, chiefs according to their generations; they lived in Jerusalem.
- 35 *And in Gibeon dwelt the father of Gibeon, Jehiel, whose wife's name was Maachah:* The father of Gibeon, Jeiel, lived in Gibeon. his wife's name was Maachah.
- 36 *And his firstborn son Abdon, then Zur, and Kish, and Baal, and Ner, and Nadab,* His firstborn son was Abdon, then Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab,
- 37 *And Gedor, and Ahio, and Zechariah, and Mikloth.* Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth.
- 38 *And Mikloth begat Shimeam. And they also dwelt with their brethren at Jerusalem, over against their brethren.* Mikloth begat Shimeam. And these also lived opposite their brothers in Jerusalem, with their brothers.
- 39 *And Ner begat Kish; and Kish begat Saul; and Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchishua, and Abinadab, and Eshbaal.* Ner begat Kish, Kish begat Saul, and Saul begat Jonathan, Malchi-shua, Abinadab, and Eshbaal.
- 40 *And the son of Jonathan was Meribbaal: and Meribbaal begat Micah.* The son of Jonathan was Merib-baal. Merib-baal begat Micah.
- 41 *And the sons of Micah were, Pithon, and Melech, and Tahrea, and Ahaz.* The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz.
- 42 *And Ahaz begat Jarah; and Jarah begat Alemeth, and Azmaveth, and Zimri; and Zimri begat Moza;* Ahaz begat Jarah, and Jarah begat Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri begat Moza.
- 43 *And Moza begat Binea; and Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son.* Moza begat Binea. Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son.

- 44 *And Azel had six sons, whose names are these, Azrikam, Bocheru, and Ishmael, and Sheariah, and Obadiah, and Hanan: these were the sons of Azel.* Azel had six sons: Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. These were the sons of Azel.
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Words in this chapter:

Jeduthun (*jeh-DOO-thun*) — A musical director in David's time — Psalm titles addressed 'to' or 'after' him indicate his musical style.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 5:25-26; Neh 7:64
- v2 — Neh 7:73; Ezra 8:20; Ezra 2:58; Ezra 2:70; Ezra 2:43
- v22 — 1 Sam 9:9
- v25 — 2 Kgs 11:5
- v32 — Lev 24:5-8
- v33 — 1 Chr 6:31-33; 1 Chr 16:4-6; Ps 134:1-2; 1 Chr 25:1-31

Chapter 10

The Philistines defeated Israel on Mount Gilboa; Saul and his three sons were killed. Saul died for his unfaithfulness against the LORD, and the kingdom was turned over to David.

- 1 *Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.* Now the Philistines fought against Israel, and the men of Israel fled before the Philistines and fell slain on Mount Gilboa.

- 2 *And the Philistines followed hard after Saul, and after his sons; and the Philistines slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Malchishua, the sons of Saul.* The Philistines pressed hard after Saul and his sons, and the Philistines struck down Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malchi-shua, the sons of Saul.
- 3 *And the battle went sore against Saul, and the archers hit him, and he was wounded of the archers.* The battle pressed hard against Saul, and the archers found him. He was wounded by the archers.
- 4 *Then said Saul to his armourbearer, Draw thy sword, and thrust me through therewith; lest these uncircumcised come and abuse me. But his armourbearer would not; for he was sore afraid. So Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.* Then Saul said to his armor-bearer, "Draw your sword and run me through with it, lest these uncircumcised men come and mistreat me." But his armor-bearer would not, for he was very afraid. So Saul took his own sword and fell on it.
- 5 *And when his armourbearer saw that Saul was dead, he fell likewise on the sword, and died.* When his armor-bearer saw that Saul was dead, he also fell on his sword and died.
- 6 *So Saul died, and his three sons, and all his house died together.* So Saul died, and his three sons, and all his house died together.
- 7 *And when all the men of Israel that were in the valley saw that they fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, then they forsook their cities, and fled: and the Philistines came and dwelt in them.* When all the men of Israel who were in the valley saw that the army had fled and that Saul and his sons were dead, they abandoned their cities and fled, and the Philistines came and lived in them.
- 8 *And it came to pass on the morrow, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his sons fallen in mount Gilboa.* The next day, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, they found Saul and his sons fallen on Mount Gilboa.
- 9 *And when they had stripped him, they took his head, and his armour, and sent into the land of the Philistines round about, to carry tidings unto their idols, and to the people.* They stripped him and took his head and his armor, and sent messengers throughout the land of the Philistines to carry the good news to their idols and to the people.

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| <p>10 <i>And they put his armour in the house of their gods, and fastened his head in the temple of Dagon.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And when all Jabeshgilead heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul,</i></p> <p>12 <i>They arose, all the valiant men, and took away the body of Saul, and the bodies of his sons, and brought them to Jabesh, and buried their bones under the oak in Jabesh, and fasted seven days.</i></p> <p>13 <i>So Saul died for his transgression which he committed against the LORD, even against the word of the LORD, which he kept not, and also for asking counsel of one that had a familiar spirit, to enquire of it;</i></p> <p>14 <i>And enquired not of the LORD: therefore he slew him, and turned the kingdom unto David the son of Jesse.</i></p> | <p>They put his armor in the house of their gods and fastened his head in the temple of Dagon.</p> <p>When all the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul,</p> <p>All the valiant men arose and took away the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons, and brought them to Jabesh. They buried their bones under the oak in Jabesh and fasted for seven days.</p> <p>So Saul died for his unfaithfulness that he committed against the LORD, because of the word of the LORD that He did not keep, and also for asking counsel of one that had a familiar spirit, to enquire of it;</p> <p>He did not seek guidance from the LORD. Therefore He put Him to death and turned the kingdom over to David the son of Jesse.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v13 — Lev 20:6; Lev 19:31; 1 Sam 15:23; Isa 8:19; Deut 18:10-14

v14 — 1 Sam 15:28; 1 Sam 13:14; 1 Sam 28:17; 1 Sam 16:1

David of Israel (United Kingdom) — 1010–970 BC

Chapter 11

All Israel gathered at Hebron and anointed David king; David captured Jerusalem and made it his capital. The chapter lists David’s mighty men and their heroic exploits.

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| 1 | <i>Then all Israel gathered themselves to David unto Hebron, saying, Behold, we are thy bone and thy flesh.</i> | Then all Israel gathered to David at Hebron, saying, "We are your bone and flesh. |
| 2 | <i>And moreover in time past, even when Saul was king, thou wast he that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and the LORD thy God said unto thee, Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be ruler over my people Israel.</i> | Even before, when Saul was king, it was you who led Israel in battle and brought them home. And the LORD Your God said to You, 'You shall shepherd my people Israel, and You shall be prince over my people Israel.' |
| 3 | <i>Therefore came all the elders of Israel to the king to Hebron; and David made a covenant with them in Hebron before the LORD; and they anointed David king over Israel, according to the word of the LORD by Samuel.</i> | " " |
| 4 | <i>And David and all Israel went to Jerusalem, which is Jebus; where the Jebusites were, the inhabitants of the land.</i> | So all the elders of Israel came to the king at Hebron, and David made a covenant with them at Hebron before the LORD. And they anointed David king over Israel, according to the word of the LORD by Samuel. |
| 5 | <i>And the inhabitants of Jebus said to David, Thou shalt not come hither. Nevertheless David took the castle of Zion, which is the city of David.</i> | David and all Israel went to Jerusalem, that is, Jebus, where the Jebusites were, the inhabitants of the land. |
| 6 | <i>And David said, Whosoever smiteth the Jebusites first shall be chief and captain. So Joab the son of Zeruiah went first up, and was chief.</i> | The inhabitants of Jebus said to David, "You will not come in here." But David took the stronghold of Zion, that is, the city of David. |
| | | David had said, "Whoever strikes the Jebusites first shall be chief and commander." And Joab the son of Zeruiah went up first, so he became chief. |

- 7 *And David dwelt in the castle; therefore they called it the city of David.* David lived in the stronghold; therefore they called it the city of David.
- 8 *And he built the city round about, even from Millo round about: and Joab repaired the rest of the city.* He built the city all around, from the Millo in complete circuit, and Joab repaired the rest of the city.
- 9 *So David waxed greater and greater: for the LORD of hosts was with him.* David became greater and greater, for the LORD of hosts was with Him.
- 10 *These also are the chief of the mighty men whom David had, who strengthened themselves with him in his kingdom, and with all Israel, to make him king, according to the word of the LORD concerning Israel.* These are the chiefs of David's mighty men who gave him strong support in his kingdom, together with all Israel, to make Him king, according to the word of the LORD concerning Israel.
- 11 *And this is the number of the mighty men whom David had; Jashobeam, an Hachmonite, the chief of the captains: he lifted up his spear against three hundred slain by him at one time.* This is an account of David's mighty men: Jashobeam, a Hachmonite, the chief of the captains — he wielded his spear against three hundred whom he killed at one time.
- 12 *And after him was Eleazar the son of Dodo, the Ahohite, who was one of the three mighties.* After him was Eleazar the son of Dodo, the Ahohite. He was one of the three mighty men.
- 13 *He was with David at Pasdammim, and there the Philistines were gathered together to battle, where was a parcel of ground full of barley; and the people fled from before the Philistines.* He was with David at Pas-dammim when the Philistines gathered there for battle. There was a plot of ground full of barley, and the people had fled before the Philistines.
- 14 *And they set themselves in the midst of that parcel, and delivered it, and slew the Philistines; and the LORD saved them by a great deliverance.* But they took their stand in the middle of the plot and defended it and struck down the Philistines. And the LORD saved them by a great victory.

- 15 *Now three of the thirty captains went down to the rock to David, into the cave of Adullam; and the host of the Philistines encamped in the valley of Rephaim.* Three of the thirty chiefs went down to the rock to David at the cave of Adullam, while the army of the Philistines was encamped in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 16 *And David was then in the hold, and the Philistines' garrison was then at Bethlehem.* David was then in the stronghold, and the Philistine garrison was then at Bethlehem.
- 17 *And David longed, and said, Oh that one would give me drink of the water of the well of Bethlehem, that is at the gate!* David said longingly, "Oh that someone would give me water to drink from the well of Bethlehem that is by the gate!"
- 18 *And the three brake through the host of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem, that was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David: but David would not drink of it, but poured it out to the LORD,* Then the three broke through the Philistine camp and drew water from the well of Bethlehem that was by the gate and carried it to David. But David would not drink of it. He poured it out to the LORD
- 19 *And said, My God forbid it me, that I should do this thing: shall I drink the blood of these men that have put their lives in jeopardy? for with the jeopardy of their lives they brought it. Therefore he would not drink it. These things did these three mightiest.* Said, "Far be it from me before my God that I should do this. Shall I drink the blood of these men who went at the risk of their lives?" For at the risk of their lives they brought it. Therefore He would not drink it. These things did the three mighty men.
- 20 *And Abishai the brother of Joab, he was chief of the three: for lifting up his spear against three hundred, he slew them, and had a name among the three.* Now Abishai the brother of Joab was chief of the three. He wielded his spear against three hundred men and killed them and won a name beside the three.
- 21 *Of the three, he was more honourable than the two; for he was their captain: howbeit he attained not to the first three.* He was the most renowned of the thirty and became their commander. But He did not attain to the three.

- 22 *Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done many acts; he slew two lionlike men of Moab: also he went down and slew a lion in a pit in a snowy day.* Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was a valiant man of Kabzeel, a doer of great deeds. He struck down two heroes of Moab. He also went down and struck down a lion in a pit on a day when snow had fallen.
- 23 *And he slew an Egyptian, a man of great stature, five cubits high; and in the Egyptian's hand was a spear like a weaver's beam; and he went down to him with a staff, and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and slew him with his own spear.* He struck down an Egyptian, a man of great stature, five cubits tall. The Egyptian had a spear like a weaver's beam, but Benaiah went down to him with a staff and snatched the spear from the Egyptian's hand and killed Him with His own spear.
- 24 *These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and had the name among the three mighties.* These things Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did, and won a name beside the three mighty men.
- 25 *Behold, he was honourable among the thirty, but attained not to the first three: and David set him over his guard.* He was renowned among the thirty. But he did not attain to the three. And David set him over his bodyguard.
- 26 *Also the valiant men of the armies were, Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,* The mighty men of the armies: Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,
- 27 *Shammoth the Harorite, Helez the Pelonite,* Shammoth the Harorite, Helez the Pelonite,
- 28 *Ira the son of Ikkes the Tekoite, Abiezer the Antothite,* Ira the son of Ikkes the Tekoite, Abiezer the Anathothite,
- 29 *Sibbecai the Hushathite, Ilai the Ahohite,* Sibbecai the Hushathite, Ilai the Ahohite,
- 30 *Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the son of Baanah the Netophathite,* Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the son of Baanah the Netophathite,

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| <p>31 <i>Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah, that pertained to the children of Benjamin, Benaiah the Pirathonite,</i></p> <p>32 <i>Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel the Arbathite,</i></p> <p>33 <i>Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba the Shaalbonite,</i></p> <p>34 <i>The sons of Hashem the Gizonite, Jonathan the son of Shage the Hararite,</i></p> <p>35 <i>Ahiam the son of Sacar the Hararite, Eliphal the son of Ur,</i></p> <p>36 <i>Hepher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the Pelonite,</i></p> <p>37 <i>Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son of Ezbai,</i></p> <p>38 <i>Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar the son of Haggeri,</i></p> <p>39 <i>Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Berothite, the armourbearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah,</i></p> <p>40 <i>Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,</i></p> <p>41 <i>Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of Ahlai,</i></p> <p>42 <i>Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite, a captain of the Reubenites, and thirty with him,</i></p> <p>43 <i>Hanan the son of Maachah, and Joshaphat the Mithnite,</i></p> <p>44 <i>Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and Jehiel the sons of Hotham the Aroerite,</i></p> | <p>Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah of the sons of Benjamin, Benaiah the Pirathonite,</p> <p>Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel the Arbathite,</p> <p>Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba the Shaalbonite,</p> <p>The sons of Hashem the Gizonite, Jonathan the son of Shage the Hararite,</p> <p>Ahiam the son of Sachar the Hararite, Eliphal the son of Ur,</p> <p>Hepher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the Pelonite,</p> <p>Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son of Ezbai,</p> <p>Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar the son of Hagri,</p> <p>Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Berothite, the armor-bearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah,</p> <p>Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,</p> <p>Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of Ahlai,</p> <p>Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite, a leader of the Reubenites, and thirty with him,</p> <p>Hanan the son of Maacah, and Joshaphat the Mithnite,</p> <p>Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and Jeiel the sons of Hotham the Aroerite,</p> |
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45	<i>Jediael the son of Shimri, and Joha his brother, the Tizite,</i>	Jediael the son of Shimri, and Joha his brother the Tizite,
46	<i>Eliel the Mahavite, and Jeribai, and Joshaviah, the sons of Elnaam, and Ithmah the Moabite,</i>	Eliel the Mahavite, and Jeribai and Joshaviah the sons of Elnaam, and Ithmah the Moabite,
47	<i>Eliel, and Obed, and Jasiel the Mesobaite.</i>	Eliel, Obed, and Jaasiel the Mezobaite.

Words in this chapter:

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Ur (*ER*) — The city in Mesopotamia where Abraham was born — a sophisticated Sumerian city on the Euphrates River in modern Iraq; God called Abraham to leave it for Canaan.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Sam 5:2
- v3 — 1 Sam 16:1; 1 Sam 16:12-13
- v4 — Judg 1:21
- v6 — 2 Sam 8:16
- v9 — 2 Sam 3:1; Isa 41:10; 2 Sam 5:10; Isa 41:14; Rom 8:31
- v12 — 1 Chr 27:4
- v16 — 1 Sam 10:5

Chapter 12

Warriors from every tribe came to David at Ziklag and Hebron, joining him while he was still hiding from Saul, until a great army assembled to make him king over all Israel.

1	<i>Now these are they that came to David to Ziklag, while he yet kept himself close because of Saul the son of Kish: and they were among the mighty men, helpers of the war.</i>	These are the men who came to David at Ziklag, while he was still confined because of Saul the son of Kish. They were among the mighty men who helped in battle.
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- 2 *They were armed with bows, and could use both the right hand and the left in hurling stones and shooting arrows out of a bow, even of Saul's brethren of Benjamin.* They were armed with bows and could shoot arrows and sling stones with either the right or the left hand. They were from the tribe of Benjamin, kinsmen of Saul.
- 3 *The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; and Jeziel, and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth; and Berachah, and Jehu the Antothite,* The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; Jeziel and Pelet, sons of Azmaveth; Berachah, Jehu of Anathoth,
- 4 *And Ishmaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man among the thirty, and over the thirty; and Jeremiah, and Jahaziel, and Johanan, and Josabad the Gederathite,* Ishmaiah of Gibeon, a mighty man among the thirty and a leader over the thirty; Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, Jozabad of Gederah,
- 5 *Eluzai, and Jerimoth, and Bealiah, and Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite,* Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, Shephatiah the Haruphite,
- 6 *Elkanah, and Jesiah, and Azareel, and Joezer, and Jashobeam, the Korhites,* Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, the Korahites,
- 7 *And Joelah, and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham of Gedor.* Joelah and Zebadiah, sons of Jeroham of Gedor.
- 8 *And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as the roes upon the mountains;* From the Gadites there separated themselves to David at the stronghold in the wilderness mighty and experienced warriors, skilled in handling shield and spear, whose faces were like faces of lions and who were as swift as gazelles on the mountains:
- 9 *Ezer the first, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third,* Ezer the first, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third,
- 10 *Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth,* Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth,

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| 11 <i>Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh,</i> | Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh, |
| 12 <i>Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth,</i> | Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth, |
| 13 <i>Jeremiah the tenth, Machbanai the eleventh.</i> | Jeremiah the tenth, Machbannai the eleventh. |
| 14 <i>These were of the sons of Gad, captains of the host: one of the least was over an hundred, and the greatest over a thousand.</i> | These Gadites were commanders of the army. The least ranked was equal to a hundred, and the greatest to a thousand. |
| 15 <i>These are they that went over Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed all his banks; and they put to flight all them of the valleys, both toward the east, and toward the west.</i> | These are the men who crossed the Jordan in the first month, when it was flooding all its banks, and put to flight all those in the valleys, to the east and to the west. |
| 16 <i>And there came of the children of Benjamin and Judah to the hold unto David.</i> | Some of the sons of Benjamin and Judah came to the stronghold to David. |
| 17 <i>And David went out to meet them, and answered and said unto them, If ye be come peaceably unto me to help me, mine heart shall be knit unto you: but if ye be come to betray me to mine enemies, seeing there is no wrong in mine hands, the God of our fathers look thereon, and rebuke it.</i> | David went out to meet them and said to them, "If you have come to me in peace to help me, my heart will be united with you. But if you have come to betray me to my enemies, though my hands have done no wrong, may the God of our fathers see and rebuke it." |
| 18 <i>Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band.</i> | Then the Spirit came on Amasai, chief of the thirty. He said, "We are Yours, David, and with you, son of Jesse! Peace, peace to You, and peace to Your helpers, for Your God helps You." And David received them and made them commanders of raiding parties. |

- 19 *And there fell some of Manasseh to David, when he came with the Philistines against Saul to battle: but they helped them not: for the lords of the Philistines upon advisement sent him away, saying, He will fall to his master Saul to the jeopardy of our heads.* Some of the men of Manasseh deserted to David when he came with the Philistines for the battle against Saul. Yet he did not help the Philistines, for the rulers of the Philistines took counsel and sent him away, saying, "He will desert to his master Saul at the cost of our heads."
- 20 *As he went to Ziklag, there fell to him of Manasseh, Adnah, and Jozabad, and Jediael, and Michael, and Jozabad, and Elihu, and Zilthai, captains of the thousands that were of Manasseh.* When he went to Ziklag, these men of Manasseh deserted to him: Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai — each a commander of a thousand from Manasseh.
- 21 *And they helped David against the band of the rovers: for they were all mighty men of valour, and were captains in the host.* They helped David against the raiding parties, for they were all mighty warriors and were commanders in the army.
- 22 *For at that time day by day there came to David to help him, until it was a great host, like the host of God.* For day by day men came to David to help him, until there was a great army, like an army of God.
- 23 *And these are the numbers of the bands that were ready armed to the war, and came to David to Hebron, to turn the kingdom of Saul to him, according to the word of the LORD.* These are the numbers of the divisions of the armed troops who came to David at Hebron to turn the kingdom of Saul over to him, according to the word of the LORD.
- 24 *The children of Judah that bare shield and spear were six thousand and eight hundred, ready armed to the war.* The sons of Judah bearing shield and spear: six thousand eight hundred armed troops.
- 25 *Of the children of Simeon, mighty men of valour for the war, seven thousand and one hundred.* Of the sons of Simeon, mighty men of valor for battle: seven thousand one hundred.
- 26 *Of the children of Levi four thousand and six hundred.* Of the sons of Levi: four thousand six hundred.

- 27 *And Jehoiada was the leader of the Aaronites, and with him were three thousand and seven hundred;* Jehoiada was the leader of the Aaronites, and with Him were three thousand seven hundred.
- 28 *And Zadok, a young man mighty of valour, and of his father's house twenty and two captains.* Zadok, a young man mighty in valor, and twenty-two commanders from His father's house.
- 29 *And of the children of Benjamin, the kindred of Saul, three thousand: for hitherto the greatest part of them had kept the ward of the house of Saul.* Of the sons of Benjamin, the brothers of Saul: three thousand, for until then the greatest part of them had kept their allegiance to the house of Saul.
- 30 *And of the children of Ephraim twenty thousand and eight hundred, mighty men of valour, famous throughout the house of their fathers.* Of the sons of Ephraim: twenty thousand eight hundred, mighty men of valor, famous men in their fathers' houses.
- 31 *And of the half tribe of Manasseh eighteen thousand, which were expressed by name, to come and make David king.* Of the half-tribe of Manasseh: eighteen thousand, who were expressly named to come and make David king.
- 32 *And of the children of Issachar, which were men that had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do; the heads of them were two hundred; and all their brethren were at their commandment.* Of the sons of Issachar, men who had understanding of the times to know what Israel should do: two hundred chiefs. All their brothers under their command.
- 33 *Of Zebulun, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, with all instruments of war, fifty thousand, which could keep rank: they were not of double heart.* Of Zebulun, experienced soldiers equipped for battle with all weapons of war: fifty thousand to join David, not double-hearted.
- 34 *And of Naphtali a thousand captains, and with them with shield and spear thirty and seven thousand.* Of Naphtali: a thousand commanders and with them thirty-seven thousand men armed with shield and spear.

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| 35 | <i>And of the Danites expert in war twenty and eight thousand and six hundred.</i> | Of the Danites experienced in battle: twenty-eight thousand six hundred. |
| 36 | <i>And of Asher, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, forty thousand.</i> | Of Asher, experienced soldiers ready for battle: forty thousand. |
| 37 | <i>And on the other side of Jordan, of the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and of the half tribe of Manasseh, with all manner of instruments of war for the battle, an hundred and twenty thousand.</i> | From beyond the Jordan, of the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, equipped with all weapons of war: one hundred twenty thousand. |
| 38 | <i>All these men of war, that could keep rank, came with a perfect heart to Hebron, to make David king over all Israel: and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king.</i> | All these warriors, drawn up in battle order, came to Hebron with full intent to make David king over all Israel. Likewise, all the rest of Israel were of one mind to make David king. |
| 39 | <i>And there they were with David three days, eating and drinking: for their brethren had prepared for them.</i> | They were there with David for three days, eating and drinking, for their brothers had made preparation for them. |
| 40 | <i>Moreover they that were nigh them, even unto Issachar and Zebulun and Naphtali, brought bread on asses, and on camels, and on mules, and on oxen; and meat, meal, cakes of figs, and bunches of raisins, and wine, and oil, and oxen, and sheep abundantly: for there was joy in Israel.</i> | Also their neighbors, as far as Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali, brought food on donkeys, camels, mules, and oxen — provisions of flour, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine, oil, oxen, and sheep in abundance, for there was joy in Israel. |

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Judg 3:15; Judg 20:16
- v8 — 2 Sam 2:18; 2 Sam 23:20; 2 Sam 17:10
- v14 — Lev 26:8; Deut 32:30
- v15 — Josh 3:15
- v18 — Judg 6:34; Judg 3:10; 2 Sam 17:25; John 6:67-68
- v19 — 1 Sam 29:2-9
- v22 — 2 Sam 3:1; Job 17:9
- v23 — 1 Chr 11:10; 2 Sam 2:3-4
- v28 — 1 Chr 6:8; 2 Sam 8:17
- v29 — 2 Sam 2:8-9
- v32 — Eph 5:17; Esth 1:13; Luke 12:56-57; Prov 14:8; Isa 33:6
- v40 — 1 Sam 25:18

Chapter 13

David gathered all Israel and brought the ark of God from Kiriath-jearim on a new cart, but when Uzzah touched the ark, the LORD struck him dead. David left the ark at the house of Obed-edom.

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| 1 <i>And David consulted with the captains of thousands and hundreds, and with every leader.</i> | David consulted with the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, with every leader. |
| 2 <i>And David said unto all the congregation of Israel, If it seem good unto you, and that it be of the LORD our God, let us send abroad unto our brethren every where, that are left in all the land of Israel, and with them also to the priests and Levites which are in their cities and suburbs, that they may gather themselves unto us:</i> | David said to all the assembly of Israel, "If it seems good to You, and if it is the will of the LORD our God, let us send abroad to our brothers who remain in all the lands of Israel, and also to the priests and Levites in their cities with pasturelands, that they may be gathered to us. |
| 3 <i>And let us bring again the ark of our God to us: for we enquired not at it in the days of Saul.</i> | Then let us bring back the ark of our God to us, for we did not seek it in the days of Saul." |
| 4 <i>And all the congregation said that they would do so: for the thing was right in the eyes of all the people.</i> | The whole assembly agreed to do so, for the thing seemed right in the eyes of all the people. |

- 5 *So David gathered all Israel together, from Shihor of Egypt even unto the entering of Hemath, to bring the ark of God from Kirjathjearim.* So David assembled all Israel from the Shihor of Egypt to the entering of Hemath, to bring the ark of God from Kiriath-jearim.
- 6 *And David went up, and all Israel, to Baalah, that is, to Kirjathjearim, which belonged to Judah, to bring up thence the ark of God the LORD, that dwelleth between the cherubims, whose name is called on it.* David and all Israel went up to Baalah, that is, to Kiriath-jearim of Judah, to bring up from there the ark of God, the LORD Who is enthroned above the cherubim, which is called by His name.
- 7 *And they carried the ark of God in a new cart out of the house of Abinadab: and Uzza and Ahio drave the cart.* They carried the ark of God on a new cart, out of the house of Abinadab. Uzza and Ahio were driving the cart.
- 8 *And David and all Israel played before God with all their might, and with singing, and with harps, and with psalteries, and with timbrels, and with cymbals, and with trumpets.* David and all Israel were celebrating before God with all their might, with song and lyres and harps and tambourines and cymbals and trumpets.
- 9 *And when they came unto the threshingfloor of Chidon, Uzza put forth his hand to hold the ark; for the oxen stumbled.* When they came to the threshing floor of Chidon, Uzza put out his hand to hold the ark, for the oxen stumbled.
- 10 *And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzza, and he smote him, because he put his hand to the ark: and there he died before God.* The anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzza. He struck Him down because He put out His hand to the ark. He died there before God.
- 11 *And David was displeased, because the LORD had made a breach upon Uzza: wherefore that place is called Perezuzza to this day.* David was angry because the LORD had broken out against Uzza. That place is called Perez-uzza to this day.
- 12 *And David was afraid of God that day, saying, How shall I bring the ark of God home to me?* David was afraid of God that day. He said, "How can I bring the ark of God home to me?"

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| <p>13 <i>So David brought not the ark home to himself to the city of David, but carried it aside into the house of Obededom the Gittite.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the ark of God remained with the family of Obededom in his house three months. And the LORD blessed the house of Obededom, and all that he had.</i></p> | <p>So David did not take the ark home into the city of David, but took it aside to the house of Obed-edom the Gittite.</p> <p>The ark of God remained with the household of Obed-edom in His house for three months. And the LORD blessed the household of Obed-edom and all that He had.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v3 — 1 Sam 7:1-2; 1 Sam 23:2

v5 — 1 Sam 6:21-7:1

v10 — 1 Chr 15:15; 1 Chr 15:13

v14 — 1 Chr 26:4-5; Prov 10:22; Prov 3:9-10; Gen 30:27

Chapter 14

Hiram king of Tyre sent materials and craftsmen to build David a house; David took more wives in Jerusalem and twice defeated the Philistines as God commanded.

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| <p>1 <i>Now Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and timber of cedars, with masons and carpenters, to build him an house.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And David perceived that the LORD had confirmed him king over Israel, for his kingdom was lifted up on high, because of his people Israel.</i></p> | <p>Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar timber and masons and carpenters to build a house for him.</p> <p>David knew that the LORD had established Him as king over Israel, and that His kingdom was highly exalted for the sake of His people Israel.</p> |
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- 3 *And David took more wives at Jerusalem: and David begat more sons and daughters.* David took more wives in Jerusalem, and David begat more sons and daughters.
- 4 *Now these are the names of his children which he had in Jerusalem; Shammua, and Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon,* These are the names of the children born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
- 5 *And Ibhar, and Elishua, and Elpalet,* Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet,
- 6 *And Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia,* Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia,
- 7 *And Elishama, and Beeliada, and Eliphalet.* Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet.
- 8 *And when the Philistines heard that David was anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to seek David. And David heard of it, and went out against them.* When the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to search for David. But David heard of it and went out against them.
- 9 *And the Philistines came and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.* Now the Philistines had come and made a raid in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 10 *And David enquired of God, saying, Shall I go up against the Philistines? and wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto him, Go up; for I will deliver them into thine hand.* David inquired of God, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will You give them into my hand?" And the LORD said to Him, "Go up. I will give them into Your hand."
- 11 *So they came up to Baalperazim; and David smote them there. Then David said, God hath broken in upon mine enemies by mine hand like the breaking forth of waters: therefore they called the name of that place Baalperazim.* They came up to Baal-perazim, and David struck them down there. And David said, "God has broken through my enemies by my hand like a bursting flood." Therefore the name of that place is called Baal-perazim.
- 12 *And when they had left their gods there, David gave a commandment, and they were burned with fire.* They left their gods there, and David gave the command. They were burned with fire.

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| 13 <i>And the Philistines yet again spread themselves abroad in the valley.</i> | The Philistines made another raid in the valley. |
| 14 <i>Therefore David enquired again of God; and God said unto him, Go not up after them; turn away from them, and come upon them over against the mulberry trees.</i> | David again inquired of God. God said to Him, "You shall not go up after them; circle around them and come against them opposite the balsam trees. |
| 15 <i>And it shall be, when thou shalt hear a sound of going in the tops of the mulberry trees, that then thou shalt go out to battle: for God is gone forth before thee to smite the host of the Philistines.</i> | When you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the balsam trees, then go out to battle, for God has gone out before you to strike down the army of the Philistines." |
| 16 <i>David therefore did as God commanded him: and they smote the host of the Philistines from Gibeon even to Gazer.</i> | David did as God commanded him. They struck down the Philistine army from Gibeon to Gezer. |
| 17 <i>And the fame of David went out into all lands; and the LORD brought the fear of him upon all nations.</i> | The fame of David went out into all lands. The LORD brought the fear of Him on all nations. |

Words in this chapter:

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 89:20-37

v9 — 1 Chr 11:15

v10 — Prov 3:6

v11 — Isa 28:21; Matt 7:27; Ps 144:10; Ex 14:28; 2 Sam 5:20

v13 — 1 Chr 14:9

v15 — Isa 13:4

v17 — Deut 2:25; Josh 6:27

Chapter 15

David prepared a place for the ark and commanded that only the Levites carry it, correcting the earlier failure. The Levites brought the ark into Jerusalem with shouting, music, and celebration.

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| 1 | <i>And David made him houses in the city of David, and prepared a place for the ark of God, and pitched for it a tent.</i> | David built houses for himself in the city of David. And he prepared a place for the ark of God and pitched a tent for it. |
| 2 | <i>Then David said, None ought to carry the ark of God but the Levites: for them hath the LORD chosen to carry the ark of God, and to minister unto him for ever.</i> | Then David said, "No one but the Levites may carry the ark of God, for the LORD has chosen them to carry the ark of God and to minister to Him forever." |
| 3 | <i>And David gathered all Israel together to Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the LORD unto his place, which he had prepared for it.</i> | David assembled all Israel at Jerusalem to bring up the ark of the LORD to the place He had prepared for it. |
| 4 | <i>And David assembled the children of Aaron, and the Levites:</i> | David gathered together the sons of Aaron and the Levites: |
| 5 | <i>Of the sons of Kohath; Uriel the chief, and his brethren an hundred and twenty:</i> | Of the sons of Kohath: Uriel the chief, with one hundred twenty of his brothers; |
| 6 | <i>Of the sons of Merari; Asaiah the chief, and his brethren two hundred and twenty:</i> | Of the sons of Merari: Asaiah the chief, with two hundred twenty of his brothers; |
| 7 | <i>Of the sons of Gershom; Joel the chief, and his brethren an hundred and thirty:</i> | Of the sons of Gershom: Joel the chief, with one hundred thirty of his brothers; |
| 8 | <i>Of the sons of Elizaphan; Shemaiah the chief, and his brethren two hundred:</i> | Of the sons of Elizaphan: Shemaiah the chief, with two hundred of his brothers; |
| 9 | <i>Of the sons of Hebron; Eliel the chief, and his brethren fourscore:</i> | Of the sons of Hebron: Eliel the chief, with eighty of his brothers; |

- 10 *Of the sons of Uzziel; Amminadab the chief, and his brethren an hundred and twelve.* Of the sons of Uzziel: Amminadab the chief, with one hundred twelve of his brothers.
- 11 *And David called for Zadok and Abiathar the priests, and for the Levites, for Uriel, Asaiah, and Joel, Shemaiah, and Eliel, and Amminadab,* David called for Zadok and Abiathar the priests, and for the Levites Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab.
- 12 *And said unto them, Ye are the chief of the fathers of the Levites: sanctify yourselves, both ye and your brethren, that ye may bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel unto the place that I have prepared for it.* He said to them, "You are the heads of the fathers' houses of the Levites. Consecrate yourselves, You and Your brothers, so that You may bring up the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel, to the place I have prepared for it.
- 13 *For because ye did it not at the first, the LORD our God made a breach upon us, for that we sought him not after the due order.* For because You did not carry it the first time, the LORD our God broke out against us, because we did not seek Him according to the proper order."
- 14 *So the priests and the Levites sanctified themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel.* So the priests and the Levites consecrated themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 15 *And the children of the Levites bare the ark of God upon their shoulders with the staves thereon, as Moses commanded according to the word of the LORD.* The Levites carried the ark of God on their shoulders with the poles, as Moses had commanded according to the word of the LORD.
- 16 *And David spake to the chief of the Levites to appoint their brethren to be the singers with instruments of musick, psalteries and harps and cymbals, sounding, by lifting up the voice with joy.* David also commanded the chiefs of the Levites to appoint their brothers as the singers who should play on musical instruments, on harps and lyres and cymbals, to raise sounds of joy.

- 17 *So the Levites appointed Heman the son of Joel; and of his brethren, Asaph the son of Berechiah; and of the sons of Merari their brethren, Ethan the son of Kushaiah;* So the Levites appointed Heman the son of Joel. Among his brothers Asaph the son of Berechiah. Among the sons of Merari, their brothers, Ethan the son of Kushaiah;
- 18 *And with them their brethren of the second degree, Zechariah, Ben, and Jaaziel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Unni, Eliab, and Benaiah, and Maaseiah, and Mattithiah, and Elipheleh, and Mikneiah, and Obedom, and Jeiel, the porters.* With them their brothers of the second order: Zechariah, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, and Obed-edom and Jeiel, the gatekeepers.
- 19 *So the singers, Heman, Asaph, and Ethan, were appointed to sound with cymbals of brass;* The singers Heman, Asaph, and Ethan were to sound bronze cymbals;
- 20 *And Zechariah, and Aziel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Unni, and Eliab, and Maaseiah, and Benaiah, with psalteries on Alamoth;* Zechariah, Aziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah were to play harps according to Alamoth;
- 21 *And Mattithiah, and Elipheleh, and Mikneiah, and Obedom, and Jeiel, and Azaziah, with harps on the Sheminith to excel.* Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-edom, Jeiel, and Azaziah were to lead with lyres according to the Sheminith.
- 22 *And Chenaniah, chief of the Levites, was for song: he instructed about the song, because he was skilful.* Chenaniah, leader of the Levites in music, was put in charge of the music, for he was skillful.
- 23 *And Berechiah and Elkanah were doorkeepers for the ark.* Berechiah and Elkanah were to be gatekeepers for the ark.
- 24 *And Shebaniah, and Jehoshaphat, and Nathaneel, and Amasai, and Zechariah, and Benaiah, and Eliezer, the priests, did blow with the trumpets before the ark of God: and Obedom and Jehiah were doorkeepers for the ark.* Shebaniah, Jehoshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer, the priests, were to blow the trumpets before the ark of God. Obed-edom and Jehiah were also gatekeepers for the ark.

- 25 *So David, and the elders of Israel, and the captains over thousands, went to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the house of Obededom with joy.* So David and the elders of Israel and the commanders of thousands went to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD from the house of Obed-edom with rejoicing.
- 26 *And it came to pass, when God helped the Levites that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, that they offered seven bullocks and seven rams.* Because God helped the Levites who were carrying the ark of the covenant of the LORD, they sacrificed seven bulls and seven rams.
- 27 *And David was clothed with a robe of fine linen, and all the Levites that bare the ark, and the singers, and Chenaniah the master of the song with the singers: David also had upon him an ephod of linen.* David was clothed with a robe of fine linen, as also were all the Levites who were carrying the ark, and the singers and Chenaniah the leader of the music with the singers. David also wore a linen ephod.
- 28 *Thus all Israel brought up the ark of the covenant of the LORD with shouting, and with sound of the cornet, and with trumpets, and with cymbals, making a noise with psalteries and harps.* So all Israel brought up the ark of the covenant of the LORD with shouting, to the sound of the horn, trumpets, and cymbals, and made loud music on harps and lyres.
- 29 *And it came to pass, as the ark of the covenant of the LORD came to the city of David, that Michal the daughter of Saul looking out at a window saw king David dancing and playing: and she despised him in her heart.* As the ark of the covenant of the LORD came to the city of David, Michal the daughter of Saul looked out of the window and saw King David dancing and celebrating. She despised him in her heart.

Words in this chapter:

Alamoth (*AL-ah-moth*) — A musical term in Psalm 46 — likely indicating a soprano voice or high-pitched instrument.

Sheminith (*sheh-MEE-nith*) — A musical term meaning 'eighth' — possibly an octave lower, or a specific eight-stringed instrument.

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Chr 16:1

v2 — Deut 10:8; Num 18:1-8; Deut 31:9

v3 — 1 Kgs 8:1; 1 Chr 13:5

v12 — 2 Chr 35:6

v13 — 2 Sam 6:3; 1 Cor 14:40; 1 Cor 11:2; 1 John 1:8-10; 1 Chr 13:7-11

v15 — Num 4:15; Num 7:9

v16 — 1 Chr 13:8

v24 — 1 Chr 16:6

v26 — Num 23:29

v28 — 1 Chr 13:8

v29 — 2 Sam 6:20-23

Chapter 16

The ark was set in the tent David had pitched for it, and David appointed Levites to minister before it. David's psalm of thanksgiving praised the LORD and called on all the earth to worship Him.

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| <p>1 <i>So they brought the ark of God, and set it in the midst of the tent that David had pitched for it: and they offered burnt sacrifices and peace offerings before God.</i></p> | <p>So they brought in the ark of God and set it inside the tent that David had pitched for it. They offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before God.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And when David had made an end of offering the burnt offerings and the peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>When David had finished offering the burnt offerings and the peace offerings, He blessed the people in the name of the LORD</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he dealt to every one of Israel, both man and woman, to every one a loaf of bread, and a good piece of flesh, and a flagon of wine.</i></p> | <p>Distributed to all Israel, both men and women, to each a loaf of bread, a portion of meat, and a flagon of wine.</p> |

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| 4 | <i>And he appointed certain of the Levites to minister before the ark of the LORD, and to record, and to thank and praise the LORD God of Israel:</i> | Then He appointed some of the Levites to minister before the ark of the LORD, to invoke, to thank, and to praise the LORD, the God of Israel: |
| 5 | <i>Asaph the chief, and next to him Zechariah, Jeiel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Mattithiah, and Eliab, and Benaiah, and Obededom: and Jeiel with psalteries and with harps; but Asaph made a sound with cymbals;</i> | Asaph the chief, second to him Zechariah, then Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-edom, and Jeiel with harps and lyres; Asaph was to sound the cymbals; |
| 6 | <i>Benaiah also and Jahaziel the priests with trumpets continually before the ark of the covenant of God.</i> | Benaiah and Jahaziel the priests were to blow trumpets regularly before the ark of the covenant of God. |
| 7 | <i>Then on that day David delivered first this psalm to thank the LORD into the hand of Asaph and his brethren.</i> | On that day David first appointed that thanksgiving be sung to the LORD by Asaph and his brothers. |
| 8 | <i>Give thanks unto the LORD, call upon his name, make known his deeds among the people.</i> | Give thanks to the LORD; call on His name; make known His deeds among the peoples! |
| 9 | <i>Sing unto him, sing psalms unto him, talk ye of all his wondrous works.</i> | Sing to Him, sing praises to Him; tell of all His wondrous works! |
| 10 | <i>Glory ye in his holy name: let the heart of them rejoice that seek the LORD.</i> | Glory in His holy name; let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice! |
| 11 | <i>Seek the LORD and his strength, seek his face continually.</i> | Seek the LORD and His strength; seek His presence continually! |
| 12 | <i>Remember his marvellous works that he hath done, his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth;</i> | Remember the wondrous works that He has done, His miracles and the judgments He has spoken, |
| 13 | <i>O ye seed of Israel his servant, ye children of Jacob, his chosen ones.</i> | O seed of Israel his servant, sons of Jacob, his chosen ones! |

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| 14 | <i>He is the LORD our God; his judgments are in all the earth.</i> | He is the LORD our God; His judgments are in all the earth. |
| 15 | <i>Be ye mindful always of his covenant; the word which he commanded to a thousand generations;</i> | Remember His covenant forever, the word that He commanded for a thousand generations, |
| 16 | <i>Even of the covenant which he made with Abraham, and of his oath unto Isaac;</i> | The covenant that he made with Abraham. His sworn promise to Isaac, |
| 17 | <i>And hath confirmed the same to Jacob for a law, and to Israel for an everlasting covenant,</i> | Which he confirmed to Jacob as a statute, to Israel as an everlasting covenant, |
| 18 | <i>Saying, Unto thee will I give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance;</i> | Saying, "To you I will give the land of Canaan, as your portion for an inheritance." |
| 19 | <i>When ye were but few, even a few, and strangers in it.</i> | When you were few in number, very few, and sojourners in it, |
| 20 | <i>And when they went from nation to nation, and from one kingdom to another people;</i> | Wandering from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another people, |
| 21 | <i>He suffered no man to do them wrong: yea, he reprov'd kings for their sakes,</i> | He allowed no one to oppress them; he rebuked kings on their account, |
| 22 | <i>Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm.</i> | Saying, "Touch not my anointed ones, do my prophets no harm!" |
| 23 | <i>Sing unto the LORD, all the earth; shew forth from day to day his salvation.</i> | Sing to the LORD, all the earth! Tell of His salvation from day to day. |
| 24 | <i>Declare his glory among the heathen; his marvellous works among all nations.</i> | Declare His glory among the nations, his marvelous works among all the peoples! |
| 25 | <i>For great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised: he also is to be feared above all gods.</i> | For great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised. He is to be feared above all gods. |

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| 26 <i>For all the gods of the people are idols: but the LORD made the heavens.</i> | For all the gods of the peoples are idols. But the LORD made the heavens. |
| 27 <i>Glory and honour are in his presence; strength and gladness are in his place.</i> | Splendor and majesty are before Him; strength and joy are in His place. |
| 28 <i>Give unto the LORD, ye kindreds of the people, give unto the LORD glory and strength.</i> | Ascribe to the LORD, O clans of the peoples, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength! |
| 29 <i>Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name: bring an offering, and come before him: worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.</i> | Ascribe to the LORD the glory due His name; bring an offering and come before Him! Worship the LORD in the splendor of holiness; |
| 30 <i>Fear before him, all the earth: the world also shall be stable, that it be not moved.</i> | Tremble before Him, all the earth! Yes, the world is established; it shall never be moved. |
| 31 <i>Let the heavens be glad, and let the earth rejoice: and let men say among the nations, The LORD reigneth.</i> | Let the heavens be glad and let the earth rejoice, and let them say among the nations, "The LORD reigns!" |
| 32 <i>Let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof: let the fields rejoice, and all that is therein.</i> | Let the sea roar. All it contains; let the fields rejoice, and everything in them! |
| 33 <i>Then shall the trees of the wood sing out at the presence of the LORD, because he cometh to judge the earth.</i> | Then shall the trees of the forest sing for joy before the LORD, for He comes to judge the earth. |
| 34 <i>O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Oh give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; for His mercy endures forever! |
| 35 <i>And say ye, Save us, O God of our salvation, and gather us together, and deliver us from the heathen, that we may give thanks to thy holy name, and glory in thy praise.</i> | Say also: "Save us, O God of our salvation, and gather and deliver us from among the nations, that we may give thanks to your holy name and glory in Your praise." |

- 36 *Blessed be the LORD God of Israel for ever and ever. And all the people said, Amen, and praised the LORD.* Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting! And all the people said "Amen!" and praised the LORD.
- 37 *So he left there before the ark of the covenant of the LORD Asaph and his brethren, to minister before the ark continually, as every day's work required:* Then David left Asaph and his brothers there before the ark of the covenant of the LORD to minister regularly before the ark as each day required,
- 38 *And Obededom with their brethren, threescore and eight; Obededom also the son of Jeduthun and Hosah to be porters:* Also Obed-edom and His sixty-eight brothers, while Obed-edom the son of Jeduthun and Hosah were to be gatekeepers.
- 39 *And Zadok the priest, and his brethren the priests, before the tabernacle of the LORD in the high place that was at Gibeon,* He left Zadok the priest and his brothers the priests before the tent of the LORD at the high place that was at Gibeon,
- 40 *To offer burnt offerings unto the LORD upon the altar of the burnt offering continually morning and evening, and to do according to all that is written in the law of the LORD, which he commanded Israel;* To offer burnt offerings to the LORD on the altar of burnt offering regularly morning and evening, in accordance with all that is written in the Law of the LORD that He commanded Israel.
- 41 *And with them Heman and Jeduthun, and the rest that were chosen, who were expressed by name, to give thanks to the LORD, because his mercy endureth for ever;* With them were Heman and Jeduthun and the rest of those chosen and expressly named to give thanks to the LORD, for His mercy endures forever.
- 42 *And with them Heman and Jeduthun with trumpets and cymbals for those that should make a sound, and with musical instruments of God. And the sons of Jeduthun were porters.* Heman and Jeduthun had trumpets and cymbals for the music and instruments for sacred song. The sons of Jeduthun were appointed to the gate.

- 43 *And all the people departed every man to his house: and David returned to bless his house.* Then all the people departed each to his house, and David went home to bless his household.

Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Jacob (JAY-kub) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Canaan (KAY-nan) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v8 — Ps 105:1-15; Isa 12:4; 2 Kgs 19:19; Ps 145:5-6; 1 Cor 1:2
v10 — Matt 7:7-8; Jer 29:13; Ps 34:2; Prov 8:17; Isa 55:6-7
v11 — Ps 27:8-9; Zeph 2:2-3; Ps 68:35; Ps 24:6; Ps 67:1
v21 — Gen 20:3; Gen 12:17; Ex 7:15-18; Gen 31:29
v22 — Gen 20:7; Ps 105:15; Gen 49:8-10
v27 — Ps 96:6; Ps 16:11; Ps 43:2-4; Ps 28:7-8
v28 — 1 Cor 15:10; Phil 4:13; Ps 100:1-2; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Eph 1:17-19
v29 — Ps 100:4; Ps 96:9; Isa 6:3; Ps 108:3-5; Ps 96:6
v31 — Ps 96:10; Ps 99:1; Ps 97:1; Rev 19:6
v34 — Ps 106:1; 2 Chr 7:3; Ezra 3:11; Ps 107:1; Ps 136:1-26
v35 — Ps 106:47-48; 1 Pet 2:9
v36 — 1 Kgs 8:15; Ps 72:18-19; Neh 8:6; 1 Kgs 8:56

Chapter 17

David told Nathan the prophet he wanted to build a house for God, but the LORD sent word that David's son would build the temple. God promised David an everlasting dynasty, and David responded in prayer and worship.

- 1 *Now it came to pass, as David sat in his house, that David said to Nathan the prophet, Lo, I dwell in an house of cedars, but the ark of the covenant of the LORD remaineth under curtains.* Now when David lived in his house, David said to Nathan the prophet, "I dwell in a house of cedar, but the ark of the covenant of the LORD is under a tent."
- 2 *Then Nathan said unto David, Do all that is in thine heart; for God is with thee.* Nathan said to David, "Do all that is in your heart, for God is with you."

- 3 *And it came to pass the same night, that the word of God came to Nathan, saying,* But that same night the word of God came to Nathan, saying,
- 4 *Go and tell David my servant, Thus saith the LORD, Thou shalt not build me an house to dwell in:* "Go and tell my servant David, 'Thus says the LORD: You shall not build me a house to dwell in.
- 5 *For I have not dwelt in an house since the day that I brought up Israel unto this day; but have gone from tent to tent, and from one tabernacle to another.* For I have not lived in a house since the day I brought up Israel to this day. But I have gone from tent to tent and from one dwelling to another.
- 6 *Wheresoever I have walked with all Israel, spake I a word to any of the judges of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people, saying, Why have ye not built me an house of cedars?* In all places where I moved with all Israel, did I speak a word with any of the judges of Israel whom I commanded to shepherd my people, saying, "Why have You not built me a house of cedar?"
- 7 *Now therefore thus shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheepcote, even from following the sheep, that thou shouldest be ruler over my people Israel:* Now therefore thus shall You say to my servant David, 'Thus says the LORD of hosts, I took You from the pasture, from following the flock, to be prince over my people Israel,
- 8 *And I have been with thee whithersoever thou hast walked, and have cut off all thine enemies from before thee, and have made thee a name like the name of the great men that are in the earth.* I have been with You wherever You went and have cut off all Your enemies before You. And I will make for You a name, like the name of the great ones of the earth.
- 9 *Also I will ordain a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, and they shall dwell in their place, and shall be moved no more; neither shall the children of wickedness waste them any more, as at the beginning,* I will appoint a place for my people Israel and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place and be disturbed no more. And the children of wickedness shall waste them no more, as formerly,

- 10 *And since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. Moreover I will subdue all thine enemies. Furthermore I tell thee that the LORD will build thee an house.* From the time that I appointed judges over my people Israel. And I will humble all Your enemies. Moreover, I declare to You that the LORD will build You a house.
- 11 *And it shall come to pass, when thy days be expired that thou must go to be with thy fathers, that I will raise up thy seed after thee, which shall be of thy sons; and I will establish his kingdom.* When Your days are fulfilled to walk with Your fathers, I will raise up Your seed after You, one of Your own sons. I will establish His kingdom.
- 12 *He shall build me an house, and I will stablish his throne for ever.* He shall build a house for me. I will establish His throne forever.
- 13 *I will be his father, and he shall be my son: and I will not take my mercy away from him, as I took it from him that was before thee:* I will be to Him a father. He shall be to me a son. I will not take my mercy from Him, as I took it from Him who was before You,
- 14 *But I will settle him in mine house and in my kingdom for ever: and his throne shall be established for evermore.* But I will confirm Him in my house and in my kingdom forever. His throne shall be established forever.' "
- 15 *According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak unto David.* In accordance with all these words and all this vision, Nathan spoke to David.
- 16 *And David the king came and sat before the LORD, and said, Who am I, O LORD God, and what is mine house, that thou hast brought me hitherto?* Then King David went in and sat before the LORD and said, "Who am I, O LORD God, and what is my house that You have brought me this far?

- 17 *And yet this was a small thing in thine eyes, O God; for thou hast also spoken of thy servant's house for a great while to come, and hast regarded me according to the estate of a man of high degree, O LORD God.* This was a small thing in Your eyes, O God. You have also spoken of Your servant's house for a great while to come, and have shown me future generations, O LORD God!
- 18 *What can David speak more to thee for the honour of thy servant? for thou knowest thy servant.* What more can David say to you for honoring your servant? For you know your servant.
- 19 *O LORD, for thy servant's sake, and according to thine own heart, hast thou done all this greatness, in making known all these great things.* For Your servant's sake, O LORD, and according to Your own heart, You have done all this greatness, in making known all these great things.
- 20 *O LORD, there is none like thee, neither is there any God beside thee, according to all that we have heard with our ears.* There is none like You, O LORD, and there is no God besides You, according to all that we have heard with our ears.
- 21 *And what one nation in the earth is like thy people Israel, whom God went to redeem to be his own people, to make thee a name of greatness and terribleness, by driving out nations from before thy people, whom thou hast redeemed out of Egypt?* Who is like Your people Israel, the one nation on earth whom God went to redeem to be His people, making Yourself a name for great and awesome things by driving out nations before Your people whom You redeemed from Egypt?
- 22 *For thy people Israel didst thou make thine own people for ever; and thou, LORD, becamest their God.* You made Your people Israel to be Your people forever, and You, O LORD, became their God.
- 23 *Therefore now, LORD, let the thing that thou hast spoken concerning thy servant and concerning his house be established for ever, and do as thou hast said.* Now, O LORD, let the word that You have spoken concerning Your servant and concerning His house be confirmed forever, and do as You have promised.

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| <p>24 <i>Let it even be established, that thy name may be magnified for ever, saying, The LORD of hosts is the God of Israel, even a God to Israel: and let the house of David thy servant be established before thee.</i></p> <p>25 <i>For thou, O my God, hast told thy servant that thou wilt build him an house: therefore thy servant hath found in his heart to pray before thee.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And now, LORD, thou art God, and hast promised this goodness unto thy servant:</i></p> <p>27 <i>Now therefore let it please thee to bless the house of thy servant, that it may be before thee for ever: for thou blessest, O LORD, and it shall be blessed for ever.</i></p> | <p>Let it be confirmed and Your name be magnified forever, saying, "The LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, is Israel's God," and the house of Your servant David will be established before you.</p> <p>For You, my God, have revealed to Your servant that You will build Him a house. Therefore Your servant has found courage to pray before You.</p> <p>Now, O LORD, You are God, and You have promised this good thing to Your servant.</p> <p>Now You have been pleased to bless the house of Your servant, that it may continue forever before You, for it is You, O LORD, who have blessed. It is blessed forever."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v8** — 1 Chr 17:2; 1 Sam 18:14; Ps 113:7-8
v10 — 2 Sam 7:11
v11 — Ps 132:11
v12 — Dan 2:44; Isa 9:7; 1 Kgs 5:5
v13 — Heb 1:5
v14 — Ps 89:36
v16 — 2 Sam 7:18; Gen 32:10
v20 — Isa 44:6
v23 — Jer 11:5; Ps 119:49; Luke 1:38; Gen 32:12; 2 Sam 7:25-29

Chapter 18

David defeated the Philistines, Moabites, Hadarezer of Zobah, and the Syrians, establishing his empire. David reigned over all Israel and administered justice and judgment to all his people.

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| 1 <i>Now after this it came to pass, that David smote the Philistines, and subdued them, and took Gath and her towns out of the hand of the Philistines.</i> | After this David defeated the Philistines and subdued them, and took Gath and its villages from the hand of the Philistines. |
| 2 <i>And he smote Moab; and the Moabites became David's servants, and brought gifts.</i> | He defeated Moab, and the Moabites became servants to David and brought tribute. |
| 3 <i>And David smote Hadarezer king of Zobah unto Hamath, as he went to stablish his dominion by the river Euphrates.</i> | David also defeated Hadarezer king of Zobah toward Hamath, as he went to stablish his dominion by the river Euphrates. |
| 4 <i>And David took from him a thousand chariots, and seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen: David also houghed all the chariot horses, but reserved of them an hundred chariots.</i> | David took from him one thousand chariots, seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand foot soldiers. David hamstringed all the chariot horses, but left enough for a hundred chariots. |
| 5 <i>And when the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadarezer king of Zobah, David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men.</i> | When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David killed twenty-two thousand men of the Syrians. |
| 6 <i>Then David put garrisons in Syriadamascus; and the Syrians became David's servants, and brought gifts. Thus the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.</i> | Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus, and the Syrians became servants to David and brought tribute. And the LORD gave victory to David wherever he went. |
| 7 <i>And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadarezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.</i> | David took the golden shields that were carried by the servants of Hadadezer and brought them to Jerusalem. |

- 8 *Likewise from Tibhath, and from Chun, cities of Hadarezer, brought David very much brass, wherewith Solomon made the brasen sea, and the pillars, and the vessels of brass.* From Tibhath and from Cun, cities of Hadadezer, David took a great amount of bronze, which Solomon used to make the bronze sea and the pillars and the vessels of bronze.
- 9 *Now when Tou king of Hamath heard how David had smitten all the host of Hadarezer king of Zobah;* When Tou king of Hamath heard that David had defeated the whole army of Hadadezer king of Zobah,
- 10 *He sent Hadoram his son to king David, to enquire of his welfare, and to congratulate him, because he had fought against Hadarezer, and smitten him; (for Hadarezer had war with Tou;) and with him all manner of vessels of gold and silver and brass.* He sent his son Hadoram to King David, to greet him and to congratulate him because he had fought against Hadadezer and defeated him — for Hadadezer had been at war with Tou — and all kinds of articles of gold, silver, and bronze.
- 11 *Them also king David dedicated unto the LORD, with the silver and the gold that he brought from all these nations; from Edom, and from Moab, and from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines, and from Amalek.* These also King David dedicated to the LORD, together with the silver and gold that He had carried off from all the nations: from Edom, Moab, the Ammonites, the Philistines, and from Amalek.
- 12 *Moreover Abishai the son of Zeruiah slew of the Edomites in the valley of salt eighteen thousand.* Abishai the son of Zeruiah killed eighteen thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt.
- 13 *And he put garrisons in Edom; and all the Edomites became David's servants. Thus the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.* He put garrisons in Edom. All the Edomites became David's servants. And the LORD gave victory to David wherever he went.
- 14 *So David reigned over all Israel, and executed judgment and justice among all his people.* So David reigned over all Israel. He administered justice and equity to all his people.
- 15 *And Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the host; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, recorder;* Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder;

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| <p>16 <i>And Zadok the son of Ahitub, and Abimelech the son of Abiathar, were the priests; and Shavsha was scribe;</i></p> <p>17 <i>And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and the sons of David were chief about the king.</i></p> | <p>Zadok the son of Ahitub and Abimelech the son of Abiathar were priests; Shavsha was secretary;</p> <p>Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites, and David's sons were the chief officials in the service of the king.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

v15 — 1 Chr 11:6

v16 — 2 Sam 8:17; 2 Sam 20:25

Chapter 19

David sent messengers to comfort Hanun king of Ammon, but Hanun humiliated them by shaving their beards and cutting their garments. Joab and Abishai defeated the Ammonites and their Syrian allies in battle.

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| <p>1 <i>Now it came to pass after this, that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon died, and his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>After this Nahash the king of the Ammonites died. His son reigned in his place.</p> |
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- 2 *And David said, I will shew kindness unto Hanun the son of Nahash, because his father shewed kindness to me. And David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. So the servants of David came into the land of the children of Ammon to Hanun, to comfort him.* David said, "I will deal loyally with Hanun the son of Nahash, for his father dealt loyally with me." So David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. And David's servants came to Hanun in the land of the Ammonites to comfort him.
- 3 *But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun, Thinkest thou that David doth honour thy father, that he hath sent comforters unto thee? are not his servants come unto thee for to search, and to overthrow, and to spy out the land?* But the princes of the Ammonites said to Hanun, "Do you think that David is honoring your father because he has sent comforters to you? Have not his servants come to you to search and to overthrow and to spy out the land?"
- 4 *Wherefore Hanun took David's servants, and shaved them, and cut off their garments in the midst hard by their buttocks, and sent them away.* So Hanun took David's servants and shaved them and cut off their garments in the middle, at their hips, and sent them away.
- 5 *Then there went certain, and told David how the men were served. And he sent to meet them: for the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, Tarry at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return.* When David was told about the men, he sent messengers to meet them, for the men were greatly humiliated. And the king said, "Remain at Jericho until your beards have grown and then return."
- 6 *And when the children of Ammon saw that they had made themselves odious to David, Hanun and the children of Ammon sent a thousand talents of silver to hire them chariots and horsemen out of Mesopotamia, and out of Syriamaachah, and out of Zobah.* When the Ammonites saw that they had made themselves odious to David, Hanun and the Ammonites sent a thousand talents of silver to hire chariots and horsemen from Mesopotamia, from Syria-maacah, and from Zobah.

- 7 *So they hired thirty and two thousand chariots, and the king of Maachah and his people; who came and pitched before Medeba. And the children of Ammon gathered themselves together from their cities, and came to battle.* They hired thirty-two thousand chariots and the king of Maacah with his army, who came and encamped before Medeba. And the Ammonites were gathered from their cities and came to battle.
- 8 *And when David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the host of the mighty men.* When David heard of it, he sent Joab and all the army of the mighty men.
- 9 *And the children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array before the gate of the city: and the kings that were come were by themselves in the field.* The Ammonites came out and drew up in battle array at the entrance of the city, and the kings who had come were by themselves in the open country.
- 10 *Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose out of all the choice of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians.* When Joab saw that the battle was set against him both in front and in the rear, he chose some of the best men of Israel and arrayed them against the Syrians.
- 11 *And the rest of the people he delivered unto the hand of Abishai his brother, and they set themselves in array against the children of Ammon.* The rest of the people he put in the charge of his brother Abishai. They were arrayed against the Ammonites.
- 12 *And he said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then thou shalt help me: but if the children of Ammon be too strong for thee, then I will help thee.* He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you shall help me; but if the Ammonites are too strong for you, then I will help you.
- 13 *Be of good courage, and let us behave ourselves valiantly for our people, and for the cities of our God: and let the LORD do that which is good in his sight.* Be strong, and let us act courageously for our people and for the cities of our God, and may the LORD do what seems good to Him."

- 14 *So Joab and the people that were with him drew nigh before the Syrians unto the battle; and they fled before him.* So Joab and the people who were with him drew near before the Syrians for battle. They fled before Him.
- 15 *And when the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were fled, they likewise fled before Abishai his brother, and entered into the city. Then Joab came to Jerusalem.* When the Ammonites saw that the Syrians fled, they likewise fled before His brother Abishai and entered the city. Then Joab came to Jerusalem.
- 16 *And when the Syrians saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they sent messengers, and drew forth the Syrians that were beyond the river: and Shophach the captain of the host of Hadarezer went before them.* But when the Syrians saw that they had been defeated by Israel, they sent messengers and brought out the Syrians who were beyond the Euphrates, with Shophach the commander of the army of Hadadezer at their head.
- 17 *And it was told David; and he gathered all Israel, and passed over Jordan, and came upon them, and set the battle in array against them. So David set the battle in array against the Syrians, and they fought with him.* When it was told David, he gathered all Israel and crossed the Jordan and came to them and drew up his forces against them. When David set the battle in array against the Syrians, they fought with him.
- 18 *But the Syrians fled before Israel; and David slew of the Syrians seven thousand men which fought in chariots, and forty thousand footmen, and killed Shophach the captain of their host.* The Syrians fled before Israel, and David killed of the Syrians seven thousand men who rode in chariots and forty thousand foot soldiers. He put to death Shophach the commander of their army.
- 19 *And when the servants of Hadarezer saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they made peace with David, and became his servants: neither would the Syrians help the children of Ammon any more.* When the servants of Hadadezer saw that they had been defeated by Israel, they made peace with David and became his servants. So the Syrians were not willing to help the Ammonites anymore.

Words in this chapter:

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

▼7 — Num 21:30; Josh 13:9

▼13 — Ps 27:14; Neh 4:14; Josh 10:25; 2 Sam 10:12; 1 Cor 16:13

Chapter 20

Joab besieged and captured Rabbah of the Ammonites, and David took their king's crown. Israelite warriors killed three Philistine giants who were descendants of the giant in Gath.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, that after the year was expired, at the time that kings go out to battle, Joab led forth the power of the army, and wasted the country of the children of Ammon, and came and besieged Rabbah. But David tarried at Jerusalem. And Joab smote Rabbah, and destroyed it.</i> | In the spring of the year, at the time when kings go out to battle, Joab led out the army and ravaged the country of the Ammonites and came and besieged Rabbah. But David remained at Jerusalem. And Joab struck down Rabbah and overthrew it. |
| 2 | <i>And David took the crown of their king from off his head, and found it to weigh a talent of gold, and there were precious stones in it; and it was set upon David's head: and he brought also exceeding much spoil out of the city.</i> | David took the crown of their king from his head and found that it weighed a talent of gold, and there was a precious stone in it. It was placed on David's head. And he brought out a very great amount of spoil from the city. |
| 3 | <i>And he brought out the people that were in it, and cut them with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes. Even so dealt David with all the cities of the children of Ammon. And David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.</i> | He brought out the people who were in it and cut them with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes. Thus David did to all the cities of the Ammonites. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem. |

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| <p>4 <i>And it came to pass after this, that there arose war at Gezer with the Philistines; at which time Sibbechai the Hushathite slew Sippai, that was of the children of the giant: and they were subdued.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And there was war again with the Philistines; and Elhanan the son of Jair slew Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, whose spear staff was like a weaver's beam.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And yet again there was war at Gath, where was a man of great stature, whose fingers and toes were four and twenty, six on each hand, and six on each foot: and he also was the son of the giant.</i></p> <p>7 <i>But when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea David's brother slew him.</i></p> <p>8 <i>These were born unto the giant in Gath; and they fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants.</i></p> | <p>After this there arose war with the Philistines at Gezer. At that time Sibbecai the Hushathite struck down Sippai, who was one of the descendants of the giants. They were subdued.</p> <p>There was war again with the Philistines, and Elhanan the son of Jair struck down Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.</p> <p>There was again war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature who had six fingers on each hand and six toes on each foot — twenty-four in all — and he also was descended from the giants.</p> <p>When he taunted Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea, David's brother, struck him down.</p> <p>These were descended from the giants in Gath. They fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Goliath (*go-LY-ath*) — The Philistine giant from Gath — over nine feet tall; defeated by the young David with a stone and sling; symbol of enemies too great for human strength.

Cross-References:

v5 — 2 Sam 21:19

Chapter 21

Satan incited David to number Israel; God sent a plague that killed seventy thousand men. David bought the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite and built an altar there, and the LORD answered with fire from heaven.

- 1 *And Satan stood up against Israel, and provoked David to number Israel.* Then Satan stood against Israel and incited David to number Israel.
- 2 *And David said to Joab and to the rulers of the people, Go, number Israel from Beersheba even to Dan; and bring the number of them to me, that I may know it.* So David said to Joab and the commanders of the people, "Go, number Israel, from Beersheba to Dan, and bring me a report, that I may know their number."
- 3 *And Joab answered, The LORD make his people an hundred times so many more as they be: but, my lord the king, are they not all my lord's servants? why then doth my lord require this thing? why will he be a cause of trespass to Israel?* But Joab said, "May the LORD add to His people a hundred times as many as they are! Are they not, my lord the king, all of them my lord's servants? Why then should my lord require this? Why should it be a cause of guilt for Israel?"
- 4 *Nevertheless the king's word prevailed against Joab. Wherefore Joab departed, and went throughout all Israel, and came to Jerusalem.* But the king's word prevailed against Joab. So Joab departed and went throughout all Israel and came back to Jerusalem.
- 5 *And Joab gave the sum of the number of the people unto David. And all they of Israel were a thousand thousand and an hundred thousand men that drew sword: and Judah was four hundred threescore and ten thousand men that drew sword.* Joab gave the sum of the numbering of the people to David. In all Israel there were one million one hundred thousand men who drew the sword, and in Judah four hundred seventy thousand who drew the sword.
- 6 *But Levi and Benjamin counted he not among them: for the king's word was abominable to Joab.* But he did not include Levi and Benjamin in the numbering, for the king's command was abhorrent to Joab.
- 7 *And God was displeased with this thing; therefore he smote Israel.* But God was displeased with this thing. He struck Israel.
- 8 *And David said unto God, I have sinned greatly, because I have done this thing: but now, I beseech thee, do away the iniquity of thy servant; for I have done very foolishly.* David said to God, "I have sinned greatly in that I have done this thing. But now, please take away the iniquity of your servant, for I have acted very foolishly."

- 9 *And the LORD spake unto Gad, David's seer, saying,* The LORD spoke to Gad, David's seer, saying,
- 10 *Go and tell David, saying, Thus saith the LORD, I offer thee three things: choose thee one of them, that I may do it unto thee.* "Go and say to David, 'Thus says the LORD, Three things I offer You; choose one of them, that I may do it to You.' "
- 11 *So Gad came to David, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Choose thee* So Gad came to David and said to him, "Thus says the LORD, 'Choose what You will:
- 12 *Either three years' famine; or three months to be destroyed before thy foes, while that the sword of thine enemies overtaketh thee; or else three days the sword of the LORD, even the pestilence, in the land, and the angel of the LORD destroying throughout all the coasts of Israel. Now therefore advise thyself what word I shall bring again to him that sent me.* Either three years of famine, or three months of devastation by Your foes, with the sword of Your enemies overtaking You, or else three days of the sword of the LORD, pestilence on the land, with the angel of the LORD destroying throughout all the territory of Israel.' Now decide what answer I shall return to Him who sent me."
- 13 *And David said unto Gad, I am in a great strait: let me fall now into the hand of the LORD; for very great are his mercies: but let me not fall into the hand of man.* Then David said to Gad, "I am in great distress. Let me fall into the hand of the LORD, for His mercies are very great, but do not let me fall into the hand of man."
- 14 *So the LORD sent pestilence upon Israel: and there fell of Israel seventy thousand men.* So the LORD sent a pestilence on Israel, and seventy thousand men of Israel fell.

- 15 *And God sent an angel unto Jerusalem to destroy it: and as he was destroying, the LORD beheld, and he repented him of the evil, and said to the angel that destroyed, It is enough, stay now thine hand. And the angel of the LORD stood by the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.* God sent the angel to Jerusalem to destroy it, but as he was about to destroy it, the LORD saw and repented Him of the evil and said to the angel who was working destruction, "It is enough; now stay Your hand." And the angel of the LORD was standing by the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.
- 16 *And David lifted up his eyes, and saw the angel of the LORD stand between the earth and the heaven, having a drawn sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem. Then David and the elders of Israel, who were clothed in sackcloth, fell upon their faces.* David lifted his eyes and saw the angel of the LORD standing between earth and heaven, and in His hand a drawn sword stretched out over Jerusalem. Then David and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fell on their faces.
- 17 *And David said unto God, Is it not I that commanded the people to be numbered? even I it is that have sinned and done evil indeed; but as for these sheep, what have they done? let thine hand, I pray thee, O LORD my God, be on me, and on my father's house; but not on thy people, that they should be plagued.* David said to God, "Was it not I who commanded the people to be counted? It is I who have sinned and done great evil. But these sheep, what have they done? O LORD my God, let Your hand be against me and against my father's house. But do not let the plague be on Your people."
- 18 *Then the angel of the LORD commanded Gad to say to David, that David should go up, and set up an altar unto the LORD in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.* Now the angel of the LORD commanded Gad to tell David to go up and raise an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.
- 19 *And David went up at the saying of Gad, which he spake in the name of the LORD.* So David went up at Gad's word, which he had spoken in the name of the LORD.

- 20 *And Ornan turned back, and saw the angel; and his four sons with him hid themselves. Now Ornan was threshing wheat.* Now Ornan turned and saw the angel. His four sons who were with him hid themselves. Ornan was threshing wheat.
- 21 *And as David came to Ornan, Ornan looked and saw David, and went out of the threshing floor, and bowed himself to David with his face to the ground.* As David came to Ornan, Ornan looked and saw David and went out from the threshing floor and paid homage to David with his face to the ground.
- 22 *Then David said to Ornan, Grant me the place of this threshing floor, that I may build an altar therein unto the LORD: thou shalt grant it me for the full price: that the plague may be stayed from the people.* David said to Ornan, "Give me the site of the threshing floor that I may build on it an altar to the LORD — give it to me at its full price — that the plague may be averted from the people."
- 23 *And Ornan said unto David, Take it to thee, and let my lord the king do that which is good in his eyes: lo, I give thee the oxen also for burnt offerings, and the threshing instruments for wood, and the wheat for the meat offering; I give it all.* Then Ornan said to David, "Take it, and let my lord the king do what seems good to him. See, I give the oxen for the burnt offerings and the threshing sledges for the wood and the wheat for the grain offering. I give it all."
- 24 *And king David said to Ornan, Nay; but I will verily buy it for the full price: for I will not take that which is thine for the LORD, nor offer burnt offerings without cost.* But King David said to Ornan, "No. But I will buy them for the full price. I will not take for the LORD what is Yours, nor offer burnt offerings that cost me nothing."
- 25 *So David gave to Ornan for the place six hundred shekels of gold by weight.* So David paid Ornan six hundred shekels of gold by weight for the site.
- 26 *And David built there an altar unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings, and called upon the LORD; and he answered him from heaven by fire upon the altar of burnt offering.* David built there an altar to the LORD and presented burnt offerings and peace offerings and called on the LORD. He answered Him with fire from heaven on the altar of burnt offering.

- 27 *And the LORD commanded the angel; and he put up his sword again into the sheath thereof.* Then the LORD commanded the angel. He put his sword back into its sheath.
- 28 *At that time when David saw that the LORD had answered him in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite, then he sacrificed there.* At that time, when David saw that the LORD had answered Him at the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite, He sacrificed there.
- 29 *For the tabernacle of the LORD, which Moses made in the wilderness, and the altar of the burnt offering, were at that season in the high place at Gibeon.* For the tent of the LORD that Moses had made in the wilderness and the altar of burnt offering were at that time in the high place at Gibeon,
- 30 *But David could not go before it to enquire of God: for he was afraid because of the sword of the angel of the LORD.* But David could not go before it to inquire of God, for He was afraid of the sword of the angel of the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Sam 24:1-25; Zech 3:1; Rev 12:10; Job 2:1; 1 Kgs 22:20-22

v5 — 2 Sam 24:9

v9 — 2 Sam 24:11; 1 Sam 9:9

v13 — Ps 130:7; Phil 1:23

v15 — Gen 6:6; Ex 32:14

v18 — 2 Chr 3:1

v23 — 2 Sam 24:22-23

v26 — Lev 9:24; Judg 6:21

v29 — 1 Chr 16:39

Chapter 22

David declared that the temple would be built on Ornan's threshing floor and began gathering materials in abundance. He charged Solomon his son to build the house of the LORD and commanded the leaders of Israel to help him.

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| <p>1 <i>Then David said, This is the house of the LORD God, and this is the altar of the burnt offering for Israel.</i></p> | Then David said, "Here shall be the house of the LORD God and here the altar of burnt offering for Israel." |
| <p>2 <i>And David commanded to gather together the strangers that were in the land of Israel; and he set masons to hew wrought stones to build the house of God.</i></p> | David commanded to gather together the resident aliens who were in the land of Israel. He set stonecutters to prepare dressed stones for building the house of God. |
| <p>3 <i>And David prepared iron in abundance for the nails for the doors of the gates, and for the joinings; and brass in abundance without weight;</i></p> | David also provided great quantities of iron for the nails for the doors of the gates and for the clamps, and so much bronze it could not be weighed; |
| <p>4 <i>Also cedar trees in abundance: for the Zidonians and they of Tyre brought much cedar wood to David.</i></p> | Cedar timber without limit, for the Sidonians and Tyrians brought great quantities of cedar to David. |
| <p>5 <i>And David said, Solomon my son is young and tender, and the house that is to be builded for the LORD must be exceeding magnifical, of fame and of glory throughout all countries: I will therefore now make preparation for it. So David prepared abundantly before his death.</i></p> | For David said, "Solomon my son is young and inexperienced, and the house that is to be built for the LORD must be greatly magnificent, famous and glorious throughout all lands. I will therefore make preparation for it." So David prepared abundantly before his death. |

- 6 *Then he called for Solomon his son, and charged him to build an house for the LORD God of Israel.* Then He called for Solomon his son and charged him to build a house for the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 7 *And David said to Solomon, My son, as for me, it was in my mind to build an house unto the name of the LORD my God:* David said to Solomon, "My son, I had it in my heart to build a house to the name of the LORD my God.
- 8 *But the word of the LORD came to me, saying, Thou hast shed blood abundantly, and hast made great wars: thou shalt not build an house unto my name, because thou hast shed much blood upon the earth in my sight.* But the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 'You have shed much blood and have waged great wars. You shall not build a house to my name, because You have shed so much blood before me on the earth.
- 9 *Behold, a son shall be born to thee, who shall be a man of rest; and I will give him rest from all his enemies round about: for his name shall be Solomon, and I will give peace and quietness unto Israel in his days.* A son shall be born to you who shall be a man of rest. I will give him rest from all his surrounding enemies. For his name shall be Solomon. I will give peace and quiet to Israel in his days.
- 10 *He shall build an house for my name; and he shall be my son, and I will be his father; and I will establish the throne of his kingdom over Israel for ever.* He shall build a house for my name. He shall be my son. I will be his father. I will establish his royal throne in Israel forever.'
- 11 *Now, my son, the LORD be with thee; and prosper thou, and build the house of the LORD thy God, as he hath said of thee.* Now, my son, the LORD be with You, so that You may succeed in building the house of the LORD Your God, as He has spoken concerning You.
- 12 *Only the LORD give thee wisdom and understanding, and give thee charge concerning Israel, that thou mayest keep the law of the LORD thy God.* Only may the LORD grant You discretion and understanding, that when He gives You charge over Israel You may keep the law of the LORD Your God.

- 13 *Then shalt thou prosper, if thou takest heed to fulfil the statutes and judgments which the LORD charged Moses with concerning Israel: be strong, and of good courage; dread not, nor be dismayed.* Then You will prosper if You are careful to observe the statutes and the rules that the LORD commanded Moses for Israel. Be strong and courageous. Fear not; do not be dismayed.
- 14 *Now, behold, in my trouble I have prepared for the house of the LORD an hundred thousand talents of gold, and a thousand thousand talents of silver; and of brass and iron without weight; for it is in abundance: timber also and stone have I prepared; and thou mayest add thereto.* With great pains I have provided for the house of the LORD one hundred thousand talents of gold, one million talents of silver, and bronze and iron beyond weighing, for there is so much of it; timber and stone too I have provided. To these You must add more.
- 15 *Moreover there are workmen with thee in abundance, hewers and workers of stone and timber, and all manner of cunning men for every manner of work.* You have an abundance of workmen: stonecutters, masons, carpenters. All kinds of craftsmen without number, skilled in working
- 16 *Of the gold, the silver, and the brass, and the iron, there is no number. Arise therefore, and be doing, and the LORD be with thee.* Gold, silver, bronze, and iron. Arise and do it! May the LORD be with You."
- 17 *David also commanded all the princes of Israel to help Solomon his son, saying,* David also commanded all the leaders of Israel to help Solomon his son, saying,
- 18 *Is not the LORD your God with you? and hath he not given you rest on every side? for he hath given the inhabitants of the land into mine hand; and the land is subdued before the LORD, and before his people.* "Is not the LORD Your God with You? And has He not given You rest on every side? For He has delivered the inhabitants of the land into my hand, and the land is subdued before the LORD and before His people.

- 19 *Now set your heart and your soul to seek the LORD your God; arise therefore, and build ye the sanctuary of the LORD God, to bring the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and the holy vessels of God, into the house that is to be built to the name of the LORD.*
- Now set Your heart and soul to seek the LORD Your God. Arise and build the sanctuary of the LORD God, so that the ark of the covenant of the LORD and the holy vessels of God may be brought into a house built for the name of the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Chr 3:1; 1 Chr 21:18-28
v3 — 1 Chr 22:14
v8 — 1 Kgs 5:3; 1 Chr 28:3
v9 — 1 Kgs 4:25
v10 — Heb 1:5
v11 — 1 Chr 22:16
v12 — Jas 1:5
v13 — 1 Chr 28:20; Josh 1:6-9; 1 Chr 28:7; Eph 6:10
v14 — 1 Chr 22:3
v16 — 1 Chr 22:11; Eph 5:14; Phil 4:13
v18 — 1 Chr 23:25; 1 Chr 22:9; 2 Sam 7:1; Rom 8:31; Acts 9:31
v19 — 1 Chr 28:9; Deut 4:29; 1 Chr 16:11; Ps 27:4; 1 Chr 22:7

Chapter 23

When David was old, he made Solomon king and numbered the Levites from thirty years old and upward. He organized the Levites into divisions for the service of the house of the LORD.

- 1 *So when David was old and full of days, he made Solomon his son king over Israel.*
- When David was old and full of days, he made Solomon his son king over Israel.
- 2 *And he gathered together all the princes of Israel, with the priests and the Levites.*
- David assembled all the leaders of Israel and the priests and the Levites.

- 3 *Now the Levites were numbered from the age of thirty years and upward: and their number by their polls, man by man, was thirty and eight thousand.* The Levites, thirty years old and upward, were counted, and the total number was thirty-eight thousand men.
- 4 *Of which, twenty and four thousand were to set forward the work of the house of the LORD; and six thousand were officers and judges:* "Twenty-four thousand of these," David said, "shall have charge of the work in the house of the LORD, six thousand shall be officers and judges,
- 5 *Moreover four thousand were porters; and four thousand praised the LORD with the instruments which I made, said David, to praise therewith.* Four thousand gatekeepers, and four thousand shall offer praises to the LORD with the instruments that I have made for praise."
- 6 *And David divided them into courses among the sons of Levi, namely, Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.* David organized them in divisions corresponding to the sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.
- 7 *Of the Gershonites were, Laadan, and Shimei.* The sons of Gershon: Ladan and Shimei.
- 8 *The sons of Laadan; the chief was Jehiel, and Zetham, and Joel, three.* The sons of Ladan: Jehiel the chief, Zetham, and Joel — three.
- 9 *The sons of Shimei; Shelomith, and Haziel, and Haran, three. These were the chief of the fathers of Laadan.* The sons of Shimei: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran — three. These were the heads of the fathers' houses of Ladan.
- 10 *And the sons of Shimei were, Jahath, Zina, and Jeush, and Beriah. These four were the sons of Shimei.* The sons of Shimei: Jahath, Zizah, Jeush, and Beriah. These four were the sons of Shimei.
- 11 *And Jahath was the chief, and Zizah the second: but Jeush and Beriah had not many sons; therefore they were in one reckoning, according to their father's house.* Jahath was the chief and Zizah the second; but Jeush and Beriah did not have many sons, so they were enrolled as a single father's house.
- 12 *The sons of Kohath; Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel, four.* The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel — four.

- 13 *The sons of Amram; Aaron and Moses: and Aaron was separated, that he should sanctify the most holy things, he and his sons for ever, to burn incense before the LORD, to minister unto him, and to bless in his name for ever.* The sons of Amram: Aaron and Moses. Aaron was set apart to dedicate the most holy things, that He and His sons should burn incense before the LORD, and minister to Him and pronounce blessings in His name forever.
- 14 *Now concerning Moses the man of God, his sons were named of the tribe of Levi.* But as for Moses the man of God, His sons were enrolled in the tribe of Levi.
- 15 *The sons of Moses were, Gershom, and Eliezer.* The sons of Moses: Gershom and Eliezer.
- 16 *Of the sons of Gershom, Shebuel was the chief.* The son of Gershom: Shebuel the chief.
- 17 *And the sons of Eliezer were, Rehabiah the chief. And Eliezer had none other sons; but the sons of Rehabiah were very many.* The sons of Eliezer: Rehabiah the chief. Eliezer had no other sons, but the sons of Rehabiah were very many.
- 18 *Of the sons of Izhar; Shelomith the chief.* The son of Izhar: Shelomith the chief.
- 19 *Of the sons of Hebron; Jeriah the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.* The sons of Hebron: Jeriah the chief, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.
- 20 *Of the sons of Uzziel; Micah the first, and Jesiah the second.* The sons of Uzziel: Micah the chief and Isshiah the second.
- 21 *The sons of Merari; Mahli, and Mushi. The sons of Mahli; Eleazar, and Kish.* The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The sons of Mahli: Eleazar and Kish.
- 22 *And Eleazar died, and had no sons, but daughters: and their brethren the sons of Kish took them.* Eleazar died having no sons, only daughters; their brothers the sons of Kish married them.
- 23 *The sons of Mushi; Mahli, and Eder, and Jeremoth, three.* The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jeremoth — three.

- 24 *These were the sons of Levi after the house of their fathers; even the chief of the fathers, as they were counted by number of names by their polls, that did the work for the service of the house of the LORD, from the age of twenty years and upward.* These were the sons of Levi by their fathers' houses, the heads of fathers' houses as they were listed by name individually, who did the work for the service of the house of the LORD, from twenty years old and upward.
- 25 *For David said, The LORD God of Israel hath given rest unto his people, that they may dwell in Jerusalem for ever:* For David said, "The LORD, the God of Israel, has given rest to His people, that they may dwell in Jerusalem forever.
- 26 *And also unto the Levites; they shall no more carry the tabernacle, nor any vessels of it for the service thereof.* So the Levites no longer need to carry the tent or any of the things for its service."
- 27 *For by the last words of David the Levites were numbered from twenty years old and above:* For by the last words of David the sons of Levi were numbered from twenty years old and upward.
- 28 *Because their office was to wait on the sons of Aaron for the service of the house of the LORD, in the courts, and in the chambers, and in the purifying of all holy things, and the work of the service of the house of God;* For their duty was to assist the sons of Aaron for the service of the house of the LORD, caring for the courts and the chambers, the cleansing of all that is holy, and any work for the service of the house of God.
- 29 *Both for the shewbread, and for the fine flour for meat offering, and for the unleavened cakes, and for that which is baked in the pan, and for that which is fried, and for all manner of measure and size;* Their duties were also for the bread of the Presence, the fine flour for the grain offering, the wafers of unleavened bread, the baked offering, the offering mixed with oil. All measures of quantity and size.
- 30 *And to stand every morning to thank and praise the LORD, and likewise at even;* They were to stand every morning, thanking and praising the LORD, and likewise at evening,

- 31 *And to offer all burnt sacrifices unto the LORD in the sabbaths, in the new moons, and on the set feasts, by number, according to the order commanded unto them, continually before the LORD:* Whenever burnt offerings were offered to the LORD on Sabbaths, new moons, and feast days, according to the number required of them, regularly before the LORD.
- 32 *And that they should keep the charge of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the charge of the holy place, and the charge of the sons of Aaron their brethren, in the service of the house of the LORD.* Thus they were to keep charge of the tent of meeting and charge of the holy place, and to attend the sons of Aaron, their brothers, for the service of the house of the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Chr 29:28; 1 Chr 28:5; 1 Kgs 1:33-39
v13 — Deut 21:5; Ex 6:20
v14 — Deut 33:1
v24 — 1 Chr 23:3; Num 10:17; Num 10:21
v25 — Ps 132:13-14; 2 Sam 7:11; 1 Chr 22:18
v26 — Num 4:5
v30 — Ps 92:1-3
v32 — Num 1:53

Chapter 24

David divided the descendants of Aaron into twenty-four divisions by lot for their priestly duties. The remaining Levites were likewise organized by lot for their service.

- 1 *Now these are the divisions of the sons of Aaron. The sons of Aaron; Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.* These are the divisions of the sons of Aaron. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

- 2 *But Nadab and Abihu died before their father, and had no children: therefore Eleazar and Ithamar executed the priest's office.* But Nadab and Abihu died before their father and had no sons, so Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests.
- 3 *And David distributed them, both Zadok of the sons of Eleazar, and Ahimelech of the sons of Ithamar, according to their offices in their service.* With the help of Zadok of the sons of Eleazar, and Ahimelech of the sons of Ithamar, David organized them according to their appointed duties in their service.
- 4 *And there were more chief men found of the sons of Eleazar than of the sons of Ithamar; and thus were they divided. Among the sons of Eleazar there were sixteen chief men of the house of their fathers, and eight among the sons of Ithamar according to the house of their fathers.* Since more leaders were found among the sons of Eleazar than among the sons of Ithamar, they were organized accordingly: sixteen heads of fathers' houses from the sons of Eleazar, and eight from the sons of Ithamar.
- 5 *Thus were they divided by lot, one sort with another; for the governors of the sanctuary, and governors of the house of God, were of the sons of Eleazar, and of the sons of Ithamar.* They were organized by lot, one group as well as the other, for there were officers of the sanctuary and officers of God among both the sons of Eleazar and the sons of Ithamar.
- 6 *And Shemaiah the son of Nethaneel the scribe, one of the Levites, wrote them before the king, and the princes, and Zadok the priest, and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, and before the chief of the fathers of the priests and Levites: one principal household being taken for Eleazar, and one taken for Ithamar.* Shemaiah the son of Nethanel, a Levite scribe, recorded them before the king, the princes, Zadok the priest, Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the priests and of the Levites — one father's house being chosen for Eleazar and one chosen for Ithamar.
- 7 *Now the first lot came forth to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah,* The first lot fell to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah,
- 8 *The third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim,* The third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim,

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| <p>9 <i>The fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin,</i></p> <p>10 <i>The seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah,</i></p> <p>11 <i>The ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah,</i></p> <p>12 <i>The eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim,</i></p> <p>13 <i>The thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab,</i></p> <p>14 <i>The fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer,</i></p> <p>15 <i>The seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Apses,</i></p> <p>16 <i>The nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezekel,</i></p> <p>17 <i>The one and twentieth to Jachin, the two and twentieth to Gamul,</i></p> <p>18 <i>The three and twentieth to Delaiah, the four and twentieth to Maaziah.</i></p> <p>19 <i>These were the orderings of them in their service to come into the house of the LORD, according to their manner, under Aaron their father, as the LORD God of Israel had commanded him.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And the rest of the sons of Levi were these: Of the sons of Amram; Shubael: of the sons of Shubael; Jehdeiah.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Concerning Rehabiah: of the sons of Rehabiah, the first was Isshiah.</i></p> | <p>The fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin,</p> <p>The seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah,</p> <p>The ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah,</p> <p>The eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim,</p> <p>The thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab,</p> <p>The fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer,</p> <p>The seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez,</p> <p>The nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezekel,</p> <p>The twenty-first to Jachin, the twenty-second to Gamul,</p> <p>The twenty-third to Delaiah, the twenty-fourth to Maaziah.</p> <p>These had their appointed duties in their service to come into the house of the LORD according to the procedure established for them by Aaron their father, as the LORD God of Israel had commanded Him.</p> <p>Of the rest of the sons of Levi: of the sons of Amram, Shubael; of the sons of Shubael, Jehdeiah.</p> <p>Of Rehabiah: of the sons of Rehabiah, Isshiah was the chief.</p> |
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| 22 | <i>Of the Izharites; Shelomoth: of the sons of Shelomoth; Jahath.</i> | Of the Izharites: Shelomoth; of the sons of Shelomoth, Jahath. |
| 23 | <i>And the sons of Hebron; Jeriah the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, Jekameam the fourth.</i> | The sons of Hebron: Jeriah the chief, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, Jekameam the fourth. |
| 24 | <i>Of the sons of Uzziel; Michah: of the sons of Michah; Shamir.</i> | The son of Uzziel: Micah; of the sons of Micah, Shamir. |
| 25 | <i>The brother of Michah was Isshiah: of the sons of Isshiah; Zechariah.</i> | The brother of Micah: Isshiah; of the sons of Isshiah, Zechariah. |
| 26 | <i>The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi: the sons of Jaaziah; Beno.</i> | The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The sons of Jaaziah: Beno. |
| 27 | <i>The sons of Merari by Jaaziah; Beno, and Shoham, and Zaccur, and Ibri.</i> | The sons of Merari by Jaaziah: Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri. |
| 28 | <i>Of Mahli came Eleazar, who had no sons.</i> | Of Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons. |
| 29 | <i>Concerning Kish: the son of Kish was Jerahmeel.</i> | Of Kish: the son of Kish, Jerahmeel. |
| 30 | <i>The sons also of Mushi; Mahli, and Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites after the house of their fathers.</i> | The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites according to their fathers' houses. |
| 31 | <i>These likewise cast lots over against their brethren the sons of Aaron in the presence of David the king, and Zadok, and Ahimelech, and the chief of the fathers of the priests and Levites, even the principal fathers over against their younger brethren.</i> | These also cast lots corresponding to their brothers the sons of Aaron in the presence of King David, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the priests and Levites, the chief fathers corresponding to their younger brothers. |

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 6:23; 1 Chr 23:6
- v2 — Lev 10:2
- v10 — Luke 1:5
- v19 — 1 Chr 9:25
- v23 — 1 Chr 23:19
- v31 — 1 Chr 24:5-6

Chapter 25

David and the army commanders set apart the sons of Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun for the ministry of prophetic music. Twenty-four divisions of temple musicians were assigned by lot, twelve men per division.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover David and the captains of the host separated to the service of the sons of Asaph, and of Heman, and of Jeduthun, who should prophesy with harps, with psalteries, and with cymbals: and the number of the workmen according to their service was:</i> | David and the commanders of the army set apart for the service the sons of Asaph, and of Heman, and of Jeduthun, who prophesied with lyres, harps, and cymbals. The list of those who did the work and their duties: |
| 2 | <i>Of the sons of Asaph; Zaccur, and Joseph, and Nathaniah, and Asarelah, the sons of Asaph under the hands of Asaph, which prophesied according to the order of the king.</i> | Of the sons of Asaph: Zaccur, Joseph, Nathaniah, and Asharelah, sons of Asaph, under the direction of Asaph, who prophesied under the direction of the king. |

- 3 *Of Jeduthun: the sons of Jeduthun; Gedaliah, and Zeri, and Jeshaiah, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah, six, under the hands of their father Jeduthun, who prophesied with a harp, to give thanks and to praise the LORD.* Of Jeduthun: the sons of Jeduthun: Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah — six — under the direction of their father Jeduthun, who prophesied with the lyre in thanksgiving and praise to the LORD.
- 4 *Of Heman: the sons of Heman; Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, and Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, and Romamtiezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth:* Of Heman: the sons of Heman: Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth.
- 5 *All these were the sons of Heman the king's seer in the words of God, to lift up the horn. And God gave to Heman fourteen sons and three daughters.* All these were the sons of Heman the king's seer in the words of God, to lift up the horn. And God gave to Heman fourteen sons and three daughters.
- 6 *All these were under the hands of their father for song in the house of the LORD, with cymbals, psalteries, and harps, for the service of the house of God, according to the king's order to Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman.* All these were under the direction of their father in the music in the house of the LORD, with cymbals, harps, and lyres for the service of the house of God. Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman were under the order of the king.
- 7 *So the number of them, with their brethren that were instructed in the songs of the LORD, even all that were cunning, was two hundred fourscore and eight.* The number of them along with their brothers who were trained in singing to the LORD, all who were skillful, was two hundred eighty-eight.
- 8 *And they cast lots, ward against ward, as well the small as the great, the teacher as the scholar.* They cast lots for their duties, the small and the great alike, the teacher and the student.
- 9 *Now the first lot came forth for Asaph to Joseph: the second to Gedaliah, who with his brethren and sons were twelve:* The first lot fell for Asaph to Joseph; the second to Gedaliah, he and his brothers and his sons, twelve;

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| <p>10 <i>The third to Zaccur, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>11 <i>The fourth to Izri, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>12 <i>The fifth to Nethaniah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>13 <i>The sixth to Bukkiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>14 <i>The seventh to Jesharelah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>15 <i>The eighth to Jeshaiiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>16 <i>The ninth to Mattaniah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>17 <i>The tenth to Shimei, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>18 <i>The eleventh to Azareel, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>19 <i>The twelfth to Hashabiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>20 <i>The thirteenth to Shubael, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>21 <i>The fourteenth to Mattithiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>22 <i>The fifteenth to Jeremoth, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>23 <i>The sixteenth to Hananiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> <p>24 <i>The seventeenth to Joshbekashah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i></p> | <p>The third to Zaccur, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The fourth to Izri, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The fifth to Nethaniah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The sixth to Bukkiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The seventh to Jesharelah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The eighth to Jeshaiiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The ninth to Mattaniah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The tenth to Shimei, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The eleventh to Azarel, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The twelfth to Hashabiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The thirteenth to Shubael, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The fourteenth to Mattithiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The fifteenth to Jeremoth, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The sixteenth to Hananiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> <p>The seventeenth to Joshbekashah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;</p> |
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25	<i>The eighteenth to Hanani, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The eighteenth to Hanani, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
26	<i>The nineteenth to Mallothi, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The nineteenth to Mallothi, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
27	<i>The twentieth to Eliathah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The twentieth to Eliathah, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
28	<i>The one and twentieth to Hothir, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The twenty-first to Hothir, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
29	<i>The two and twentieth to Giddalti, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The twenty-second to Giddalti, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
30	<i>The three and twentieth to Mahazioth, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:</i>	The twenty-third to Mahazioth, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
31	<i>The four and twentieth to Romamtiezer, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve.</i>	The twenty-fourth to Romamti-ezer, his sons and his brothers, twelve.

Words in this chapter:

Jeduthun (*jeh-DOO-thun*) — A musical director in David's time — Psalm titles addressed 'to' or 'after' him indicate his musical style.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Kgs 3:15; 1 Chr 6:33; 1 Chr 6:39; 1 Sam 10:5
- v2 — 1 Chr 25:6
- v8 — 1 Chr 26:13

Chapter 26

The gatekeepers were organized by divisions from the families of Korah and Merari, with assignments to the four sides of the temple. Other Levites were appointed over the treasures and as officers and judges.

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| <p>1 <i>Concerning the divisions of the porters: Of the Korhites was Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And the sons of Meshelemiah were, Zechariah the firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth,</i></p> <p>3 <i>Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, Elioenai the seventh.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Moreover the sons of Obededom were, Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, and Sacar the fourth, and Nethaneel the fifth,</i></p> <p>5 <i>Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peulthai the eighth: for God blessed him.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Also unto Shemaiah his son were sons born, that ruled throughout the house of their father: for they were mighty men of valour.</i></p> <p>7 <i>The sons of Shemaiah; Othni, and Rephael, and Obed, Elzabad, whose brethren were strong men, Elihu, and Semachiah.</i></p> <p>8 <i>All these of the sons of Obededom: they and their sons and their brethren, able men for strength for the service, were threescore and two of Obededom.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Meshelemiah had sons and brethren, strong men, eighteen.</i></p> | <p>As for the divisions of the gatekeepers: of the Korahites, Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph.</p> <p>Meshelemiah had sons: Zechariah the firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth,</p> <p>Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, Eliehoenai the seventh.</p> <p>Obed-edom had sons: Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, Sachar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth,</p> <p>Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peullethai the eighth, for God blessed him.</p> <p>Also to his son Shemaiah were sons born who ruled over their father's house, for they were mighty men of valor.</p> <p>The sons of Shemaiah: Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad, whose brothers were able men — Elihu and Semachiah.</p> <p>All these were among the sons of Obed-edom with their sons and brothers, able men qualified for the service — sixty-two of Obed-edom.</p> <p>Meshelemiah had sons and brothers, able men — eighteen.</p> |
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- 10 *Also Hosah, of the children of Merari, had sons; Simri the chief, (for though he was not the firstborn, yet his father made him the chief;)* Hosah, of the sons of Merari, had sons: Shimri the chief (for though he was not the firstborn, his father made him chief),
- 11 *Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, Zechariah the fourth: all the sons and brethren of Hosah were thirteen.* Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, Zechariah the fourth: all the sons and brothers of Hosah were thirteen.
- 12 *Among these were the divisions of the porters, even among the chief men, having wards one against another, to minister in the house of the LORD.* These divisions of the gatekeepers, corresponding to their chief men, had duties, just as their brothers did, ministering in the house of the LORD.
- 13 *And they cast lots, as well the small as the great, according to the house of their fathers, for every gate.* They cast lots by fathers' houses, small and great alike, for each gate.
- 14 *And the lot eastward fell to Shelemiah. Then for Zechariah his son, a wise counsellor, they cast lots; and his lot came out northward.* The lot for the east fell to Shelemiah. They cast lots also for his son Zechariah, a shrewd counselor. His lot came out for the north.
- 15 *To Obededom southward; and to his sons the house of Asuppim.* Obed-edom's lot came out for the south, and to his sons the storehouse.
- 16 *To Shuppim and Hosah the lot came forth westward, with the gate Shallecheth, by the causeway of the going up, ward against ward.* For Shuppim and Hosah it came out for the west, by the gate of Shallecheth on the road that goes up. Watch was opposite watch.
- 17 *Eastward were six Levites, northward four a day, southward four a day, and toward Asuppim two and two.* On the east there were six each day, on the north four each day, on the south four each day, and at the storehouse two and two.
- 18 *At Parbar westward, four at the causeway, and two at Parbar.* At the Parbar on the west there were four at the road and two at the Parbar.
- 19 *These are the divisions of the porters among the sons of Kore, and among the sons of Merari.* These were the divisions of the gatekeepers among the sons of Korah and the sons of Merari.

- 20 *And of the Levites, Ahijah was over the treasures of the house of God, and over the treasures of the dedicated things.* Of the Levites, Ahijah had charge of the treasures of the house of God and the treasures of the dedicated gifts.
- 21 *As concerning the sons of Laadan; the sons of the Gershonite Laadan, chief fathers, even of Laadan the Gershonite, were Jehieli.* The sons of Ladan, the sons of the Gershonite Ladan, the heads of the fathers' houses belonging to Ladan the Gershonite: Jehieli.
- 22 *The sons of Jehieli; Zetham, and Joel his brother, which were over the treasures of the house of the LORD.* The sons of Jehieli: Zetham and Joel his brother, who were over the treasures of the house of the LORD.
- 23 *Of the Amramites, and the Izharites, the Hebronites, and the Uzzielites:* Of the Amramites, the Izharites, the Hebronites, and the Uzzielites:
- 24 *And Shebuel the son of Gershom, the son of Moses, was ruler of the treasures.* Shebuel the son of Gershom, the son of Moses, was ruler of the treasures.
- 25 *And his brethren by Eliezer; Rehabiah his son, and Jeshaiah his son, and Joram his son, and Zichri his son, and Shelomith his son.* His brothers through Eliezer: Rehabiah his son, Jeshaiah his son, Joram his son, Zichri his son, and Shelomoth his son.
- 26 *Which Shelomith and his brethren were over all the treasures of the dedicated things, which David the king, and the chief fathers, the captains over thousands and hundreds, and the captains of the host, had dedicated.* This Shelomoth and his brothers were over all the treasures of the dedicated gifts that David the king, and the heads of the fathers' houses, and the officers of the thousands and hundreds, and the commanders of the army had dedicated.
- 27 *Out of the spoils won in battles did they dedicate to maintain the house of the LORD.* From the spoils of wars they dedicated gifts for the maintenance of the house of the LORD.

- 28 *And all that Samuel the seer, and Saul the son of Kish, and Abner the son of Ner, and Joab the son of Zeruiah, had dedicated; and whosoever had dedicated any thing, it was under the hand of Shelomith, and of his brethren.* Also all that Samuel the seer had dedicated, and Saul the son of Kish, Abner the son of Ner, and Joab the son of Zeruiah — whatever anyone had dedicated was in the care of Shelomoth and his brothers.
- 29 *Of the Izharites, Chenaniah and his sons were for the outward business over Israel, for officers and judges.* Of the Izharites: Chenaniah and his sons were appointed to outside duties for Israel as officers and judges.
- 30 *And of the Hebronites, Hashabiah and his brethren, men of valour, a thousand and seven hundred, were officers among them of Israel on this side Jordan westward in all the business of the LORD, and in the service of the king.* Of the Hebronites: Hashabiah and His brothers, one thousand seven hundred men of ability, had the oversight of Israel west of the Jordan for all the LORD's business and for the service of the king.
- 31 *Among the Hebronites was Jerijah the chief, even among the Hebronites, according to the generations of his fathers. In the fortieth year of the reign of David they were sought for, and there were found among them mighty men of valour at Jazer of Gilead.* Among the Hebronites, Jerijah was chief of the Hebronites, according to the genealogies of their fathers. In the fortieth year of David's reign search was made, and men of great ability were found among them at Jazer in Gilead.
- 32 *And his brethren, men of valour, were two thousand and seven hundred chief fathers, whom king David made rulers over the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh, for every matter pertaining to God, and affairs of the king.* King David appointed him and his brothers — two thousand seven hundred men of ability, heads of fathers' houses — over the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, for every matter pertaining to God and for the affairs of the king.

Words in this chapter:

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v13 — 1 Chr 25:8; 1 Chr 24:31
- v29 — 1 Chr 23:4; Neh 11:16
- v31 — 1 Chr 23:19

Chapter 27

The twelve monthly military divisions are listed, each with twenty-four thousand men and a commander. The chapter also records the tribal leaders, David's overseers of royal property, and his counselors.

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| 1 | <i>Now the children of Israel after their number, to wit, the chief fathers and captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers that served the king in any matter of the courses, which came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, of every course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | This is the list of the people of Israel — the heads of fathers' houses, the commanders of thousands and hundreds. Their officers who served the king in all matters of the divisions that came and went, month after month throughout the year. Each division numbered twenty-four thousand. |
| 2 | <i>Over the first course for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel was in charge of the first division in the first month; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |
| 3 | <i>Of the children of Perez was the chief of all the captains of the host for the first month.</i> | He was one of the sons of Perez and was chief of all the commanders for the first month. |

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| 4 | <i>And over the course of the second month was Dodai an Ahohite, and of his course was Mikloth also the ruler: in his course likewise were twenty and four thousand.</i> | Dodai the Ahohite was in charge of the division of the second month; in his division were twenty-four thousand, and Mikloth was the chief officer. |
| 5 | <i>The third captain of the host for the third month was Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, a chief priest: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | The third commander, for the third month, was Benaiah the son of Jehoiada the priest, as chief; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |
| 6 | <i>This is that Benaiah, who was mighty among the thirty, and above the thirty: and in his course was Ammizabad his son.</i> | This is the Benaiah who was a mighty man of the thirty and in command of the thirty; Ammizabad his son was in charge of his division. |
| 7 | <i>The fourth captain for the fourth month was Asahel the brother of Joab, and Zebadiah his son after him: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | The fourth, for the fourth month, was Asahel the brother of Joab, and after him Zebadiah his son; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |
| 8 | <i>The fifth captain for the fifth month was Shamhuth the Izrahite: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | The fifth, for the fifth month, was Shamhuth the Izrahite; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |
| 9 | <i>The sixth captain for the sixth month was Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | The sixth, for the sixth month, was Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |
| 10 | <i>The seventh captain for the seventh month was Helez the Pelonite, of the children of Ephraim: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i> | The seventh, for the seventh month, was Helez the Pelonite, of the sons of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand. |

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| <p>11 <i>The eighth captain for the eighth month was Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zarhites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i></p> <p>12 <i>The ninth captain for the ninth month was Abiezer the Anethothite, of the Benjamites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i></p> <p>13 <i>The tenth captain for the tenth month was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zarhites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i></p> <p>14 <i>The eleventh captain for the eleventh month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the children of Ephraim: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i></p> <p>15 <i>The twelfth captain for the twelfth month was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Furthermore over the tribes of Israel: the ruler of the Reubenites was Eliezer the son of Zichri: of the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maachah:</i></p> <p>17 <i>Of the Levites, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel: of the Aaronites, Zadok:</i></p> <p>18 <i>Of Judah, Elihu, one of the brethren of David: of Issachar, Omri the son of Michael:</i></p> <p>19 <i>Of Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah: of Naphtali, Jerimoth the son of Azriel:</i></p> | <p>The eighth, for the eighth month, was Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zerahites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.</p> <p>The ninth, for the ninth month, was Abiezer of Anathoth, a Benjaminite; in his division were twenty-four thousand.</p> <p>The tenth, for the tenth month, was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zerahites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.</p> <p>The eleventh, for the eleventh month, was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the sons of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand.</p> <p>The twelfth, for the twelfth month, was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel; in his division were twenty-four thousand.</p> <p>Over the tribes of Israel: for the Reubenites, Eliezer the son of Zichri was chief; for the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maacah;</p> <p>For Levi, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel; for Aaron, Zadok;</p> <p>For Judah, Elihu, one of David's brothers; for Issachar, Omri the son of Michael;</p> <p>For Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah; for Naphtali, Jerimoth the son of Azriel;</p> |
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- 20 *Of the children of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah: of the half tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiiah:* For the sons of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah; for the half-tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiiah;
- 21 *Of the half tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah: of Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner:* For the half-tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah; for Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner;
- 22 *Of Dan, Azareel the son of Jeroham. These were the princes of the tribes of Israel.* For Dan, Azarel the son of Jeroham. These were the leaders of the tribes of Israel.
- 23 *But David took not the number of them from twenty years old and under: because the LORD had said he would increase Israel like to the stars of the heavens.* David did not number those below twenty years of age, for the LORD had promised to make Israel as many as the stars of heaven.
- 24 *Joab the son of Zeruiah began to number, but he finished not, because there fell wrath for it against Israel; neither was the number put in the account of the chronicles of king David.* Joab the son of Zeruiah began to count but did not finish. Wrath came upon Israel because of this, and the number was not entered in the chronicles of King David.
- 25 *And over the king's treasures was Azmaveth the son of Adiel: and over the storehouses in the fields, in the cities, and in the villages, and in the castles, was Jehonathan the son of Uziah:* Azmaveth the son of Adiel was over the king's treasures. Jehonathan the son of Uziah was over the storehouses in the country, in the cities, in the villages, and in the towers.
- 26 *And over them that did the work of the field for tillage of the ground was Ezri the son of Chelub:* Ezri the son of Chelub was over those who worked the fields and tilled the ground.
- 27 *And over the vineyards was Shimei the Ramathite: over the increase of the vineyards for the wine cellars was Zabdi the Shiphmite:* Shimei the Ramathite was over the vineyards. Zabdi the Shiphmite was over the produce of the vineyards for the wine cellars.

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| <p>28 <i>And over the olive trees and the sycamore trees that were in the low plains was Baalhanan the Gederite: and over the cellars of oil was Joash:</i></p> <p>29 <i>And over the herds that fed in Sharon was Shitrai the Sharonite: and over the herds that were in the valleys was Shaphat the son of Adlai:</i></p> <p>30 <i>Over the camels also was Obil the Ishmaelite: and over the asses was Jehdeiah the Meronothite:</i></p> <p>31 <i>And over the flocks was Jaziz the Hagerite. All these were the rulers of the substance which was king David's.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Also Jonathan David's uncle was a counsellor, a wise man, and a scribe: and Jehiel the son of Hachmoni was with the king's sons:</i></p> <p>33 <i>And Ahithophel was the king's counsellor: and Hushai the Archite was the king's companion:</i></p> <p>34 <i>And after Ahithophel was Jehoiada the son of Benaiah, and Abiathar: and the general of the king's army was Joab.</i></p> | <p>Baal-hanan the Gederite was over the olive and sycamore trees in the Shephelah; Joash was over the stores of oil.</p> <p>Shitrai the Sharonite was over the herds that grazed in Sharon; Shaphat the son of Adlai was over the herds in the valleys.</p> <p>Obil the Ishmaelite was over the camels; Jehdeiah the Meronothite was over the donkeys.</p> <p>Jaziz the Hagrite was over the flocks. All these were the stewards of King David's property.</p> <p>Jonathan, David's uncle, was a counselor — he was a man of understanding and also a scribe. Jehiel the son of Hachmoni attended the king's sons.</p> <p>Ahithophel was the king's counselor, and Hushai the Archite was the king's friend.</p> <p>After Ahithophel came Jehoiada the son of Benaiah, and Abiathar. The commander of the king's army was Joab.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Naphtali (NAF-tah-ly) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Zebulun (ZEB-yoo-lun) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Chr 11:11; 2 Sam 23:8

v11 — 2 Sam 21:18

v23 — Gen 15:5

v33 — 2 Sam 15:12; 2 Sam 15:37

v34 — 1 Kgs 1:7; 1 Chr 11:6

Chapter 28

David assembled all the leaders of Israel and publicly charged Solomon to build the temple, presenting him with the divinely inspired plans for every detail of the house of God and its service.

- 1 And David assembled all the princes of Israel, the princes of the tribes, and the captains of the companies that ministered to the king by course, and the captains over the thousands, and the captains over the hundreds, and the stewards over all the substance and possession of the king, and of his sons, with the officers, and with the mighty men, and with all the valiant men, unto Jerusalem.*

David assembled at Jerusalem all the leaders of Israel — the leaders of the tribes, the commanders of the divisions that served the king, the commanders of thousands, the commanders of hundreds, the stewards of all the property and livestock of the king and his sons, together with the palace officials, the mighty men and all the valiant men, to Jerusalem.
- 2 Then David the king stood up upon his feet, and said, Hear me, my brethren, and my people: As for me, I had in mine heart to build an house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and for the footstool of our God, and had made ready for the building:*

Then King David rose to his feet and said: "Hear me, my brothers and my people. I had it in my heart to build a house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the LORD and for the footstool of our God. I made preparations for building.
- 3 But God said unto me, Thou shalt not build an house for my name, because thou hast been a man of war, and hast shed blood.*

But God said to me, 'You may not build a house for my name, for You are a man of war and have shed blood.'

- 4 *Howbeit the LORD God of Israel chose me before all the house of my father to be king over Israel for ever: for he hath chosen Judah to be the ruler; and of the house of Judah, the house of my father; and among the sons of my father he liked me to make me king over all Israel:* Yet the LORD God of Israel chose me from all my father's house to be king over Israel forever. For He chose Judah as leader, and in the house of Judah my father's house, and among my father's sons He took pleasure in me to make me king over all Israel.
- 5 *And of all my sons, (for the LORD hath given me many sons,) he hath chosen Solomon my son to sit upon the throne of the kingdom of the LORD over Israel.* Of all my sons — for the LORD has given me many sons — He has chosen Solomon my son to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the LORD over Israel.
- 6 *And he said unto me, Solomon thy son, he shall build my house and my courts: for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father.* He said to me, 'It is Solomon your son who shall build my house and my courts, for I have chosen him to be my son. I will be his father.
- 7 *Moreover I will establish his kingdom for ever, if he be constant to do my commandments and my judgments, as at this day.* I will establish his kingdom forever if he continues resolute in keeping my commandments and my rules, as he is today.'
- 8 *Now therefore in the sight of all Israel the congregation of the LORD, and in the audience of our God, keep and seek for all the commandments of the LORD your God: that ye may possess this good land, and leave it for an inheritance for your children after you for ever.* Now therefore in the sight of all Israel, the assembly of the LORD, and in the hearing of our God, observe and seek all the commandments of the LORD Your God, that You may possess this good land and leave it for an inheritance to Your children after You forever.

- 9 *And thou, Solomon my son, know thou the God of thy father, and serve him with a perfect heart and with a willing mind: for the LORD searcheth all hearts, and understandeth all the imaginations of the thoughts: if thou seek him, he will be found of thee; but if thou forsake him, he will cast thee off for ever.* You, Solomon my son, know the God of Your father and serve Him with a whole heart and with a willing mind, for the LORD searches all hearts and understands every plan and thought. If You seek Him, He will be found by You, but if You forsake Him, He will cast You off forever.
- 10 *Take heed now; for the LORD hath chosen thee to build an house for the sanctuary: be strong, and do it.* Take care now, for the LORD has chosen You to build a house for the sanctuary; be strong and do it."
- 11 *Then David gave to Solomon his son the pattern of the porch, and of the houses thereof, and of the treasures thereof, and of the upper chambers thereof, and of the inner parlours thereof, and of the place of the mercy seat,* Then David gave Solomon his son the plan of the vestibule of the temple, and of its houses, its treasures, its upper rooms, and its inner rooms, and of the room for the mercy seat;
- 12 *And the pattern of all that he had by the spirit, of the courts of the house of the LORD, and of all the chambers round about, of the treasures of the house of God, and of the treasures of the dedicated things:* The plan of all that He had in mind for the courts of the house of the LORD, all the surrounding chambers, the treasures of the house of God, and the treasures for dedicated gifts;
- 13 *Also for the courses of the priests and the Levites, and for all the work of the service of the house of the LORD, and for all the vessels of service in the house of the LORD.* For the divisions of the priests and of the Levites. All the work of the service in the house of the LORD; for all the vessels for the service in the house of the LORD.
- 14 *He gave of gold by weight for things of gold, for all instruments of all manner of service; silver also for all instruments of silver by weight, for all instruments of every kind of service:* He gave Him the weight of gold for all golden vessels for each service, the weight of silver vessels for each service,

- 15 *Even the weight for the candlesticks of gold, and for their lamps of gold, by weight for every candlestick, and for the lamps thereof: and for the candlesticks of silver by weight, both for the candlestick, and also for the lamps thereof, according to the use of every candlestick.* The weight of the golden lampstands and their lamps of gold, by weight for each lampstand and its lamps. The weight of silver for a lampstand and its lamps, according to the use of each lampstand.
- 16 *And by weight he gave gold for the tables of shewbread, for every table; and likewise silver for the tables of silver:* He gave the weight of gold for each table for the bread of the Presence. The weight of silver for the tables of silver;
- 17 *Also pure gold for the fleshhooks, and the bowls, and the cups: and for the golden basons he gave gold by weight for every bason; and likewise silver by weight for every bason of silver:* Pure gold for the forks, the basins, and the cups; for the golden bowls and the weight of each; for the silver bowls and the weight of each;
- 18 *And for the altar of incense refined gold by weight; and gold for the pattern of the chariot of the cherubims, that spread out their wings, and covered the ark of the covenant of the LORD.* For the altar of incense made of refined gold, and its weight; also His plan for the golden chariot of the cherubim that spread their wings and covered the ark of the covenant of the LORD.
- 19 *All this, said David, the LORD made me understand in writing by his hand upon me, even all the works of this pattern.* "All this He made clear to me in writing from the hand of the LORD, all the work to be done according to the plan."
- 20 *And David said to Solomon his son, Be strong and of good courage, and do it: fear not, nor be dismayed: for the LORD God, even my God, will be with thee; he will not fail thee, nor forsake thee, until thou hast finished all the work for the service of the house of the LORD.* Then David said to Solomon his son, "Be strong and courageous and do it. Do not be afraid and do not be dismayed, for the LORD God, even my God, is with You. He will not leave You or forsake You, until all the work for the service of the house of the LORD is finished.

- 21 *And, behold, the courses of the priests and the Levites, even they shall be with thee for all the service of the house of God: and there shall be with thee for all manner of workmanship every willing skilful man, for any manner of service: also the princes and all the people will be wholly at thy commandment.* The divisions of the priests and the Levites for all the service of the house of God — every willing man who has skill for any kind of service is with You. The leaders and all the people will be fully at your command."
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Words in this chapter:

mercy seat — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 23:2; 1 Chr 11:10-47
- v3** — 1 Chr 22:8; 1 Chr 17:4
- v4** — 1 Sam 16:1; 1 Chr 5:2
- v6** — 2 Sam 7:13-14
- v7** — 1 Chr 22:13
- v9** — Jer 29:13; Jas 4:8-11; Matt 7:7-8; Isa 55:6-7; Jer 24:7
- v10** — 1 Chr 28:6
- v11** — 1 Chr 28:19
- v12** — 1 Chr 26:20
- v18** — Ex 25:18-22
- v19** — 1 Chr 28:11-12; Ex 25:40
- v20** — 1 Chr 22:13; Isa 41:10; Josh 1:5-9; Heb 13:5; 1 Cor 16:13

Chapter 29

David and the leaders gave generously from their own wealth for the temple, and the people gave willingly. David praised the LORD before the assembly, Solomon was made king a second time, and David died after reigning forty years.

- 1 *Furthermore David the king said unto all the congregation, Solomon my son, whom alone God hath chosen, is yet young and tender, and the work is great: for the palace is not for man, but for the LORD God.* David the king said to all the assembly, "Solomon my son, whom alone God has chosen, is young and inexperienced, and the work is great, for the palace will not be for man but for the LORD God.
- 2 *Now I have prepared with all my might for the house of my God the gold for things to be made of gold, and the silver for things of silver, and the brass for things of brass, the iron for things of iron, and wood for things of wood; onyx stones, and stones to be set, glistering stones, and of divers colours, and all manner of precious stones, and marble stones in abundance.* So I have provided for the house of my God, so far as I was able, the gold for the things of gold, the silver for the things of silver, the bronze for the things of bronze, the iron for the things of iron, and wood for the things of wood, besides great quantities of onyx and stones for setting, antimony, colored stones, all sorts of precious stones, and marble.
- 3 *Moreover, because I have set my affection to the house of my God, I have of mine own proper good, of gold and silver, which I have given to the house of my God, over and above all that I have prepared for the holy house,* Moreover, in addition to all that I have provided for the holy house, I have a treasure of my own of gold and silver, and because of my devotion to the house of my God I give it to the house of my God:
- 4 *Even three thousand talents of gold, of the gold of Ophir, and seven thousand talents of refined silver, to overlay the walls of the houses withal:* Three thousand talents of gold, of the gold of Ophir, and seven thousand talents of refined silver, for overlaying the walls of the houses,
- 5 *The gold for things of gold, and the silver for things of silver, and for all manner of work to be made by the hands of artificers. And who then is willing to consecrate his service this day unto the LORD?* For all the work to be done by craftsmen — gold for the things of gold and silver for the things of silver. Who then will offer willingly, consecrating Himself today to the LORD?"

- 6 *Then the chief of the fathers and princes of the tribes of Israel, and the captains of thousands and of hundreds, with the rulers of the king's work, offered willingly,* Then the leaders of fathers' houses made their freewill offerings, as did also the leaders of the tribes, the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and the officers over the king's work.
- 7 *And gave for the service of the house of God of gold five thousand talents and ten thousand drams, and of silver ten thousand talents, and of brass eighteen thousand talents, and one hundred thousand talents of iron.* They gave for the service of the house of God five thousand talents and ten thousand darics of gold, ten thousand talents of silver, eighteen thousand talents of bronze, and one hundred thousand talents of iron.
- 8 *And they with whom precious stones were found gave them to the treasure of the house of the LORD, by the hand of Jehiel the Gershonite.* Whoever had precious stones gave them to the treasury of the house of the LORD, in the care of Jehiel the Gershonite.
- 9 *Then the people rejoiced, for that they offered willingly, because with perfect heart they offered willingly to the LORD: and David the king also rejoiced with great joy.* Then the people rejoiced because these had given willingly, for with a whole heart they had offered freely to the LORD. David the king also rejoiced greatly.
- 10 *Wherefore David blessed the LORD before all the congregation: and David said, Blessed be thou, LORD God of Israel our father, for ever and ever.* Therefore David blessed the LORD in the presence of all the assembly. David said: "Blessed are you, O LORD, the God of Israel our father, forever and ever.
- 11 *Thine, O LORD, is the greatness, and the power, and the glory, and the victory, and the majesty: for all that is in the heaven and in the earth is thine; thine is the kingdom, O LORD, and thou art exalted as head above all.* Yours, O LORD, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is Yours. Yours is the kingdom, O LORD, and You are exalted as head above all.

- 12 *Both riches and honour come of thee, and thou reignest over all; and in thine hand is power and might; and in thine hand it is to make great, and to give strength unto all.* Both riches and honor come from You, and You rule over all. In Your hand are power and might, and in Your hand it is to make great and to give strength to all.
- 13 *Now therefore, our God, we thank thee, and praise thy glorious name.* Now we thank You, our God, and praise Your glorious name.
- 14 *But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able to offer so willingly after this sort? for all things come of thee, and of thine own have we given thee.* But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able to offer willingly like this? For all things come from You, and of Your own have we given You.
- 15 *For we are strangers before thee, and sojourners, as were all our fathers: our days on the earth are as a shadow, and there is none abiding.* For we are strangers before You and sojourners, as all our fathers were. Our days on the earth are like a shadow, and there is no abiding.
- 16 *O LORD our God, all this store that we have prepared to build thee an house for thine holy name cometh of thine hand, and is all thine own.* O LORD our God, all this abundance that we have provided for building You a house for Your holy name comes from Your hand and is all Your own.
- 17 *I know also, my God, that thou triest the heart, and hast pleasure in uprightness. As for me, in the uprightness of mine heart I have willingly offered all these things: and now have I seen with joy thy people, which are present here, to offer willingly unto thee.* I know, my God, that You test the heart and have pleasure in uprightness. In the uprightness of my heart I have freely offered all these things, and now I have seen Your people who are present here offering freely and joyously to You.
- 18 *O LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this for ever in the imagination of the thoughts of the heart of thy people, and prepare their heart unto thee:* O LORD, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep forever such purposes and thoughts in the hearts of Your people, and direct their hearts toward You.

- 19 *And give unto Solomon my son a perfect heart, to keep thy commandments, thy testimonies, and thy statutes, and to do all these things, and to build the palace, for the which I have made provision.* Grant to Solomon my son a whole heart that he may keep your commandments, your testimonies, and your statutes, performing all, and that he may build the palace for which I have made provision."
- 20 *And David said to all the congregation, Now bless the LORD your God. And all the congregation blessed the LORD God of their fathers, and bowed down their heads, and worshipped the LORD, and the king.* Then David said to all the assembly, "Bless the LORD Your God." And all the assembly blessed the LORD, the God of their fathers, and bowed their heads and paid homage to the LORD and to the king.
- 21 *And they sacrificed sacrifices unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings unto the LORD, on the morrow after that day, even a thousand bullocks, a thousand rams, and a thousand lambs, with their drink offerings, and sacrifices in abundance for all Israel:* They offered sacrifices to the LORD, and on the next day offered burnt offerings to the LORD — a thousand bulls, a thousand rams, and a thousand lambs, with their drink offerings, and sacrifices in abundance for all Israel.
- 22 *And did eat and drink before the LORD on that day with great gladness. And they made Solomon the son of David king the second time, and anointed him unto the LORD to be the chief governor, and Zadok to be priest.* They ate and drank before the LORD on that day with great gladness. And they made Solomon the son of David king the second time. They anointed him as prince for the LORD, and Zadok as priest.
- 23 *Then Solomon sat on the throne of the LORD as king instead of David his father, and prospered; and all Israel obeyed him.* Then Solomon sat on the throne of the LORD as king in place of David his father. He prospered. All Israel obeyed him.
- 24 *And all the princes, and the mighty men, and all the sons likewise of king David, submitted themselves unto Solomon the king.* All the leaders and the mighty men, and also all the sons of King David, pledged their allegiance to King Solomon.

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| <p>25 <i>And the LORD magnified Solomon exceedingly in the sight of all Israel, and bestowed upon him such royal majesty as had not been on any king before him in Israel.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Thus David the son of Jesse reigned over all Israel.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And the time that he reigned over Israel was forty years; seven years reigned he in Hebron, and thirty and three years reigned he in Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And he died in a good old age, full of days, riches, and honour: and Solomon his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Now the acts of David the king, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of Samuel the seer, and in the book of Nathan the prophet, and in the book of Gad the seer,</i></p> <p>30 <i>With all his reign and his might, and the times that went over him, and over Israel, and over all the kingdoms of the countries.</i></p> | <p>The LORD magnified Solomon exceedingly in the sight of all Israel and bestowed on Him such royal majesty as had not been on any king before Him in Israel.</p> <p>Thus David the son of Jesse reigned over all Israel.</p> <p>The time that he reigned over Israel was forty years. He reigned seven years in Hebron and thirty-three years in Jerusalem.</p> <p>Then he died at a good old age, full of days, riches, and honor, and Solomon his son reigned in his place.</p> <p>Now the acts of King David, from first to last, are written in the Chronicles of Samuel the seer, and in the Chronicles of Nathan the prophet, and in the Chronicles of Gad the seer,</p> <p>With accounts of all his reign and his might and of the circumstances that came upon him and upon Israel and upon all the kingdoms of the lands.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v9** — 2 Cor 9:7-8; 2 Cor 8:3
v10 — Eph 1:3; Rom 1:7; 1 Pet 1:3; 1 Tim 1:17; Rev 5:12
v11 — Heb 1:3; 1 Tim 1:17; Dan 4:34-35; Jude 1:25; Rev 5:12-13
v12 — Eph 3:16; 2 Chr 20:6; Deut 8:18; Phil 4:13; Dan 6:26
v13 — 2 Cor 9:15; Ps 106:1
v14 — Jas 1:17; 2 Cor 3:5; Rom 11:36; 2 Cor 12:9-11; Ps 115:1
v15 — Ps 144:4; Lev 25:23; Ps 102:11; Ps 39:12; Job 14:2
v17 — Jer 17:10; Prov 11:20

v19 — 1 Chr 28:9; Ps 72:1

v25 — 2 Chr 1:12; 2 Chr 1:1

v28 — Gen 15:15; Acts 13:36; Job 5:26; 1 Chr 23:1; Gen 25:8

v29 — 1 Sam 9:9

2 Chronicles

Author: Ezra the priest, traditionally — Jewish tradition identifies him as the compiler of Chronicles from earlier temple records, royal annals, and the writings of the prophets.

Date written: c. 450–430 BC, after the return from Babylon.

Written to: The returned exiles in Jerusalem, who needed to understand their identity and the legitimacy of their worship.

Setting: 2 Chronicles opens at the height of Solomon's glory and traces the kingdom of Judah from the temple's dedication to the fall of Jerusalem and the Babylonian exile — ending with Cyrus's decree of return.

Where this sits historically: Written c. 450 BC during the Persian period; covers Solomon through the exile (c. 970–586 BC) from a temple-centered, priestly viewpoint.

Contemporaries: Of writing — Ezra, Nehemiah, Haggai, Zechariah, and Malachi. The events recounted parallel 1 and 2 Kings; the same prophets — Elijah, Elisha, Isaiah, Jeremiah, and others — are at work in the background.

Big themes:

- The temple — 2 Chronicles begins with its dedication and ends with its destruction; the temple is the spine of the whole narrative
- David's dynasty — the Chronicler traces only the southern kingdom (Judah), keeping the Davidic line in view as God's chosen vessel
- Revival and apostasy — the pattern of spiritual decline, divine judgment, and reformation repeats through king after king
- Prayer — decisive moments turn on whether the king and people cry out to God (Jehoshaphat, Hezekiah, Josiah)
- Exile as consequence — the fall of Jerusalem is presented not as political failure but as the inevitable result of persistent covenant breaking

Key passages: 2 Chr 7:14; 15:2; 20:12; 33:12–13; 36:22–23

How it fits: 2 Chronicles retells the same era covered by 1–2 Kings but with a priestly lens: temple worship, the Levites, and covenant faithfulness dominate the story. The final two verses deliberately echo the opening of Ezra, making Chronicles-Ezra-Nehemiah a continuous narrative of Israel's story from David to the restoration.

> **Solomon of Israel (United Kingdom) — 970–930 BC**

Chapter 1

Solomon went to the tabernacle at Gibeon and offered a thousand burnt offerings; God appeared to him there and granted his request for wisdom. God also gave Solomon surpassing

riches, wealth, and honor.

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| 1 | <i>And Solomon the son of David was strengthened in his kingdom, and the LORD his God was with him, and magnified him exceedingly.</i> | Solomon the son of David established himself in his kingdom. The LORD His God was with Him and magnified Him exceedingly. |
| 2 | <i>Then Solomon spake unto all Israel, to the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and to the judges, and to every governor in all Israel, the chief of the fathers.</i> | Solomon spoke to all Israel — to the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, to the judges, and to all the leaders of all Israel, the heads of the fathers' houses. |
| 3 | <i>So Solomon, and all the congregation with him, went to the high place that was at Gibeon; for there was the tabernacle of the congregation of God, which Moses the servant of the LORD had made in the wilderness.</i> | Solomon and all the assembly with him went to the high place that was at Gibeon, for the tent of meeting of God, which Moses the servant of the LORD had made in the wilderness, was there. |
| 4 | <i>But the ark of God had David brought up from Kirjathjearim to the place which David had prepared for it: for he had pitched a tent for it at Jerusalem.</i> | But David had brought the ark of God up from Kiriath-jearim to the place David had prepared for it, for he had pitched a tent for it in Jerusalem. |
| 5 | <i>Moreover the brasen altar, that Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, had made, he put before the tabernacle of the LORD: and Solomon and the congregation sought unto it.</i> | The bronze altar that Bezalel the son of Uri, son of Hur, had made was there before the tent of the LORD. And Solomon and the assembly sought the LORD there. |
| 6 | <i>And Solomon went up thither to the brasen altar before the LORD, which was at the tabernacle of the congregation, and offered a thousand burnt offerings upon it.</i> | Solomon went up there to the bronze altar before the LORD, which was at the tent of meeting, and offered a thousand burnt offerings on it. |
| 7 | <i>In that night did God appear unto Solomon, and said unto him, Ask what I shall give thee.</i> | In that night God appeared to Solomon and said to him, "Ask what I shall give you." |

- 8 *And Solomon said unto God, Thou hast shewed great mercy unto David my father, and hast made me to reign in his stead.* Solomon said to God, "You have shown great mercy to David my father, and have made me king in his place.
- 9 *Now, O LORD God, let thy promise unto David my father be established: for thou hast made me king over a people like the dust of the earth in multitude.* O LORD God, let Your word to David my father be now fulfilled, for you have made me king over a people as numerous as the dust of the earth.
- 10 *Give me now wisdom and knowledge, that I may go out and come in before this people: for who can judge this thy people, that is so great?* Give me now wisdom and knowledge to go out and come in before this people, for who can govern this people of Yours, which is so great?"
- 11 *And God said to Solomon, Because this was in thine heart, and thou hast not asked riches, wealth, or honour, nor the life of thine enemies, neither yet hast asked long life; but hast asked wisdom and knowledge for thyself, that thou mayest judge my people, over whom I have made thee king:* God answered Solomon, "Because this was in your heart and you have not asked for possessions, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, and have not even asked for long life, but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself that you may govern my people over whom I have made you king,
- 12 *Wisdom and knowledge is granted unto thee; and I will give thee riches, and wealth, and honour, such as none of the kings have had that have been before thee, neither shall there any after thee have the like.* Wisdom and knowledge are granted to you. I will also give you riches, possessions, and honor, such as none of the kings had who were before you, and none after you shall have the like."
- 13 *Then Solomon came from his journey to the high place that was at Gibeon to Jerusalem, from before the tabernacle of the congregation, and reigned over Israel.* So Solomon came from the high place at Gibeon, from before the tent of meeting, to Jerusalem. And he reigned over Israel.

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| <p>14 <i>And Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen: and he had a thousand and four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, which he placed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the king made silver and gold at Jerusalem as plenteous as stones, and cedar trees made he as the sycamore trees that are in the vale for abundance.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And Solomon had horses brought out of Egypt, and linen yarn: the king's merchants received the linen yarn at a price.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And they fetched up, and brought forth out of Egypt a chariot for six hundred shekels of silver, and an horse for an hundred and fifty: and so brought they out horses for all the kings of the Hittites, and for the kings of Syria, by their means.</i></p> | <p>Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen. He had fourteen hundred chariots and twelve thousand horsemen, whom he stationed in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem.</p> <p>The king made silver and gold as common in Jerusalem as stone. He made cedar as plentiful as the sycamore of the Shephelah.</p> <p>Solomon's horses were imported from Egypt and from all lands.</p> <p>They imported a chariot from Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and a horse for one hundred fifty. Likewise through them these were exported to all the kings of the Hittites and the kings of Syria.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (*shalom*).

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 29:25; 1 Kgs 2:12; Gen 39:2
v7 — Matt 7:7-8; 1 John 5:14-15; John 16:23; Prov 3:5-6; 1 Kgs 3:5-15
v8 — 1 Chr 28:5
v9 — Gen 13:16; 2 Sam 7:12-16
v10 — 1 Kgs 3:9; Prov 4:7; Prov 2:2-6; Ps 119:73; Prov 3:13-18
v11 — Jas 3:17; Prov 23:7
v12 — Jas 1:5; 2 Chr 9:22; Matt 6:33; Eph 3:20; 1 Chr 29:25
v14 — 1 Kgs 4:26; 1 Kgs 10:26-29

Chapter 2

Solomon sent word to Hiram king of Tyre requesting skilled craftsmen and timber for the temple. Hiram praised the LORD and sent Hiram-abi, a master craftsman, along with the materials.

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| <p>1 <i>And Solomon determined to build an house for the name of the LORD, and an house for his kingdom.</i></p> | Now Solomon purposed to build a temple for the name of the LORD and a royal palace for Himself. |
| <p>2 <i>And Solomon told out threescore and ten thousand men to bear burdens, and fourscore thousand to hew in the mountain, and three thousand and six hundred to oversee them.</i></p> | Solomon assigned seventy thousand men to bear loads and eighty thousand to quarry in the mountains, with three thousand six hundred to oversee them. |
| <p>3 <i>And Solomon sent to Hiram the king of Tyre, saying, As thou didst deal with David my father, and didst send him cedars to build him an house to dwell therein, even so deal with me.</i></p> | Solomon sent word to Hiram the king of Tyre: "As you dealt with David my father and sent him cedar to build himself a house to live in, so deal with me. |
| <p>4 <i>Behold, I build an house to the name of the LORD my God, to dedicate it to him, and to burn before him sweet incense, and for the continual shewbread, and for the burnt offerings morning and evening, on the sabbaths, and on the new moons, and on the solemn feasts of the LORD our God. This is an ordinance for ever to Israel.</i></p> | I am about to build a house for the name of the LORD my God and dedicate it to Him for the burning of incense of sweet spices before Him, and for the regular arrangement of the bread of the Presence, and for burnt offerings morning and evening, on the Sabbaths and the new moons and the appointed feasts of the LORD our God, as ordained forever for Israel. |

- 5 *And the house which I build is great: for great is our God above all gods.* The house that I am to build will be great, for our God is greater than all gods.
- 6 *But who is able to build him an house, seeing the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain him? who am I then, that I should build him an house, save only to burn sacrifice before him?* But who is able to build Him a house, since heaven, even highest heaven, cannot contain Him? Who am I to build a house for Him, except as a place to make offerings before Him?
- 7 *Send me now therefore a man cunning to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass, and in iron, and in purple, and crimson, and blue, and that can skill to grave with the cunning men that are with me in Judah and in Jerusalem, whom David my father did provide.* So now send me a man skilled to work in gold, silver, bronze, and iron, and in purple, crimson, and blue fabrics, trained also in engraving, to be with the skilled workers who are with me in Judah and Jerusalem, whom David my father provided.
- 8 *Send me also cedar trees, fir trees, and algum trees, out of Lebanon: for I know that thy servants can skill to cut timber in Lebanon; and, behold, my servants shall be with thy servants,* Send me also cedar, cypress, and algum timber from Lebanon, for I know that your servants know how to cut timber in Lebanon. And my servants will be with your servants,
- 9 *Even to prepare me timber in abundance: for the house which I am about to build shall be wonderful great.* To prepare timber for me in abundance, for the house I am to build will be great and wonderful.
- 10 *And, behold, I will give to thy servants, the hewers that cut timber, twenty thousand measures of beaten wheat, and twenty thousand measures of barley, and twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil.* I will give for your servants, the woodsmen who cut timber, twenty thousand cors of crushed wheat, twenty thousand cors of barley, twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil."

- 11 *Then Hiram the king of Tyre answered in writing, which he sent to Solomon, Because the LORD hath loved his people, he hath made thee king over them.* Then Hiram the king of Tyre answered in a letter that he sent to Solomon, "Because the LORD loves His people, He has made You king over them."
- 12 *Hiram said moreover, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, that made heaven and earth, who hath given to David the king a wise son, endued with prudence and understanding, that might build an house for the LORD, and an house for his kingdom.* Hiram also said, "Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, who made heaven and earth, who has given King David a wise son, with insight and understanding, who will build a temple for the LORD and a royal palace for Himself.
- 13 *And now I have sent a cunning man, endued with understanding, of Hiram my father's,* Now I have sent a skilled man, with understanding, Hiram-abi my father's,
- 14 *The son of a woman of the daughters of Dan, and his father was a man of Tyre, skilful to work in gold, and in silver, in brass, in iron, in stone, and in timber, in purple, in blue, and in fine linen, and in crimson; also to grave any manner of graving, and to find out every device which shall be put to him, with thy cunning men, and with the cunning men of my lord David thy father.* The son of a woman of the daughters of Dan. His father was a man of Tyre. He is trained to work in gold, silver, bronze, iron, stone, and wood, and in purple, blue, and crimson fabrics and fine linen, and to do all sorts of engraving and execute any design that may be assigned him, with your craftsmen, the craftsmen of my lord David your father.
- 15 *Now therefore the wheat, and the barley, the oil, and the wine, which my lord hath spoken of, let him send unto his servants:* Now therefore the wheat and barley, oil and wine, of which my lord has spoken, let him send to his servants.
- 16 *And we will cut wood out of Lebanon, as much as thou shalt need: and we will bring it to thee in floats by sea to Joppa; and thou shalt carry it up to Jerusalem.* We will cut whatever timber you need from Lebanon and bring it to you in rafts by sea to Joppa, so that you may take it up to Jerusalem."

- 17 *And Solomon numbered all the strangers that were in the land of Israel, after the numbering wherewith David his father had numbered them; and they were found an hundred and fifty thousand and three thousand and six hundred.* Then Solomon counted all the resident aliens who were in the land of Israel, after the census of them that David his father had taken, and there were found one hundred fifty-three thousand six hundred.
- 18 *And he set threescore and ten thousand of them to be bearers of burdens, and fourscore thousand to be hewers in the mountain, and three thousand and six hundred overseers to set the people a work.* Seventy thousand of them he assigned to bear loads, eighty thousand to quarry in the mountains, and three thousand six hundred as overseers to make the people work.

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Chr 2:18
- v3 — 1 Chr 14:1
- v4 — Ex 30:7
- v5 — 1 Chr 16:25
- v6 — Isa 66:1; 2 Chr 6:18; 1 Kgs 8:27; Acts 7:48-49
- v11 — 2 Chr 9:8; 1 Kgs 10:9
- v12 — Ps 33:6
- v15 — 2 Chr 2:10
- v17 — 1 Chr 22:2

Chapter 3

Solomon began building the temple on Mount Moriah in the fourth year of his reign. The chapter describes the dimensions of the house, the most holy place overlaid with gold, the cherubim, the veil, and the two bronze pillars named Jachin and Boaz.

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| 1 | <i>Then Solomon began to build the house of the LORD at Jerusalem in mount Moriah, where the LORD appeared unto David his father, in the place that David had prepared in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.</i> | Then Solomon began to build the house of the LORD in Jerusalem on Mount Moriah, where the LORD had appeared to David his father, at the place David had appointed, on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. |
| 2 | <i>And he began to build in the second day of the second month, in the fourth year of his reign.</i> | He began to build in the second month of the fourth year of His reign. |
| 3 | <i>Now these are the things wherein Solomon was instructed for the building of the house of God. The length by cubits after the first measure was threescore cubits, and the breadth twenty cubits.</i> | These are Solomon's foundations for building the house of God. The length, in cubits of the old standard, was sixty cubits, and the width twenty cubits. |
| 4 | <i>And the porch that was in the front of the house, the length of it was according to the breadth of the house, twenty cubits, and the height was an hundred and twenty: and he overlaid it within with pure gold.</i> | The vestibule in front of the nave of the house was twenty cubits long, equal to the width of the house, and its height was one hundred twenty cubits. He overlaid it on the inside with pure gold. |
| 5 | <i>And the greater house he cieled with fir tree, which he overlaid with fine gold, and set thereon palm trees and chains.</i> | The main nave he lined with cypress and covered it with fine gold and made palm trees and chains on it. |
| 6 | <i>And he garnished the house with precious stones for beauty: and the gold was gold of Parvaim.</i> | He also adorned the house with precious stones. The gold was gold of Parvaim. |

- 7 *He overlaid also the house, the beams, the posts, and the walls thereof, and the doors thereof, with gold; and graved cherubims on the walls.* So he lined the house with gold — the beams, the thresholds, its walls, and its doors — and he carved cherubim on the walls.
- 8 *And he made the most holy house, the length whereof was according to the breadth of the house, twenty cubits, and the breadth thereof twenty cubits: and he overlaid it with fine gold, amounting to six hundred talents.* He made the most holy place. Its length, corresponding to the width of the house, was twenty cubits, and its width was twenty cubits. He overlaid it with six hundred talents of fine gold.
- 9 *And the weight of the nails was fifty shekels of gold. And he overlaid the upper chambers with gold.* The weight of the nails was fifty shekels of gold. And he overlaid the upper chambers with gold.
- 10 *And in the most holy house he made two cherubims of image work, and overlaid them with gold.* In the most holy place he made two cherubim of wood and overlaid them with gold.
- 11 *And the wings of the cherubims were twenty cubits long: one wing of the one cherub was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house: and the other wing was likewise five cubits, reaching to the wing of the other cherub.* The total wingspan of the cherubim was twenty cubits: one wing of the first cherub was five cubits, touching the wall of the house, and the other wing was five cubits, touching the wing of the other cherub;
- 12 *And one wing of the other cherub was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house: and the other wing was five cubits also, joining to the wing of the other cherub.* One wing of the other cherub was five cubits, touching the wall of the house, and the other wing was also five cubits, touching the wing of the first cherub.
- 13 *The wings of these cherubims spread themselves forth twenty cubits: and they stood on their feet, and their faces were inward.* The wings of these cherubim extended twenty cubits. The cherubim stood on their feet, facing the nave.

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| <p>14 <i>And he made the vail of blue, and purple, and crimson, and fine linen, and wrought cherubims thereon.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Also he made before the house two pillars of thirty and five cubits high, and the chapter that was on the top of each of them was five cubits.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And he made chains, as in the oracle, and put them on the heads of the pillars; and made an hundred pomegranates, and put them on the chains.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And he reared up the pillars before the temple, one on the right hand, and the other on the left; and called the name of that on the right hand Jachin, and the name of that on the left Boaz.</i></p> | <p>He made the veil of blue and purple and crimson fabrics and fine linen. He worked cherubim into it.</p> <p>In front of the house he made two pillars thirty-five cubits high, with a capital of five cubits on the top of each.</p> <p>He made chains like a necklace and put them on the tops of the pillars. He made one hundred pomegranates and put them on the chains.</p> <p>He set up the pillars in front of the temple, one on the right and one on the left; the one on the right he called Jachin, and the one on the left he called Boaz.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Boaz (*BO-az*) — A wealthy landowner in Bethlehem who married Ruth — he acted as her kinsman-redeemer; ancestor of King David; his name means 'in him is strength.'

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Chr 21:18; Gen 22:14

v8 — Ex 26:33

Chapter 4

Solomon made the bronze altar, the great molten sea resting on twelve oxen, ten lavers, ten golden lampstands, ten tables, and the courts. Hiram-abi completed all the bronze and gold furnishings for the house of God.

- 1 *Moreover he made an altar of brass, twenty cubits the length thereof, and twenty cubits the breadth thereof, and ten cubits the height thereof.* He made an altar of bronze, twenty cubits long, twenty cubits wide, and ten cubits high.
- 2 *Also he made a molten sea of ten cubits from brim to brim, round in compass, and five cubits the height thereof; and a line of thirty cubits did compass it round about.* Then he made the sea of cast metal. It was round, ten cubits from brim to brim, and five cubits high. A line of thirty cubits measured its circumference.
- 3 *And under it was the similitude of oxen, which did compass it round about: ten in a cubit, compassing the sea round about. Two rows of oxen were cast, when it was cast.* Under it was the similitude of oxen encircling it, ten to a cubit, surrounding the sea all around. Two rows of oxen were cast, when it was cast.
- 4 *It stood upon twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, and three looking toward the west, and three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east: and the sea was set above upon them, and all their hinder parts were inward.* It stood on twelve oxen, three facing north, three facing west, three facing south, and three facing east. The sea was set on them. All their rear parts were inward.
- 5 *And the thickness of it was an handbreadth, and the brim of it like the work of the brim of a cup, with flowers of lilies; and it received and held three thousand baths.* Its thickness was a handbreadth. And its brim was made like the brim of a cup, like the flower of a lily. It held three thousand baths.
- 6 *He made also ten lavers, and put five on the right hand, and five on the left, to wash in them: such things as they offered for the burnt offering they washed in them; but the sea was for the priests to wash in.* He also made ten basins in which to wash, and set five on the right side and five on the left, to rinse off what was used for the burnt offering; the sea was for the priests to wash in.

- 7 *And he made ten candlesticks of gold according to their form, and set them in the temple, five on the right hand, and five on the left.* He made ten golden lampstands as prescribed and set them in the temple, five on the right side and five on the left.
- 8 *He made also ten tables, and placed them in the temple, five on the right side, and five on the left. And he made an hundred basons of gold.* He also made ten tables and placed them in the temple, five on the right side and five on the left. And he made one hundred basins of gold.
- 9 *Furthermore he made the court of the priests, and the great court, and doors for the court, and overlaid the doors of them with brass.* He made the court of the priests and the great court and doors for the court, and overlaid their doors with bronze.
- 10 *And he set the sea on the right side of the east end, over against the south.* He set the sea at the southeast corner of the house.
- 11 *And Hiram made the pots, and the shovels, and the basons. And Hiram finished the work that he was to make for king Solomon for the house of God;* Hiram also made the pots, the shovels, and the basins. So Hiram finished the work that he did for King Solomon on the house of God:
- 12 *To wit, the two pillars, and the pommels, and the chapters which were on the top of the two pillars, and the two wreaths to cover the two pommels of the chapters which were on the top of the pillars;* The two pillars, the bowls, and the two capitals on top of the pillars. The two latticeworks to cover the two bowls of the capitals on top of the pillars;
- 13 *And four hundred pomegranates on the two wreaths; two rows of pomegranates on each wreath, to cover the two pommels of the chapters which were upon the pillars.* Four hundred pomegranates for the two latticeworks, two rows of pomegranates for each latticework, to cover the two bowls of the capitals on top of the pillars.
- 14 *He made also bases, and lavers made he upon the bases;* He also made the stands and the basins on the stands,
- 15 *One sea, and twelve oxen under it.* The one sea, and the twelve oxen underneath it;

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| <p>16 <i>The pots also, and the shovels, and the fleshhooks, and all their instruments, did Hiram his father make to king Solomon for the house of the LORD of bright brass.</i></p> <p>17 <i>In the plain of Jordan did the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zeredathah.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Thus Solomon made all these vessels in great abundance: for the weight of the brass could not be found out.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And Solomon made all the vessels that were for the house of God, the golden altar also, and the tables whereon the shewbread was set;</i></p> <p>20 <i>Moreover the candlesticks with their lamps, that they should burn after the manner before the oracle, of pure gold;</i></p> <p>21 <i>And the flowers, and the lamps, and the tongs, made he of gold, and that perfect gold;</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the snuffers, and the basons, and the spoons, and the censers, of pure gold: and the entry of the house, the inner doors thereof for the most holy place, and the doors of the house of the temple, were of gold.</i></p> | <p>The pots, the shovels, and the forks — all these utensils Hiram-abi made of burnished bronze for King Solomon for the house of the LORD.</p> <p>In the plain of the Jordan the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zeredah.</p> <p>Solomon made all these things in great quantities, for the weight of the bronze was not determined.</p> <p>So Solomon made all the furnishings that were in the house of God: the golden altar, the tables for the bread of the Presence,</p> <p>The lampstands and their lamps of pure gold to burn before the inner sanctuary as prescribed,</p> <p>The flowers, the lamps, and the tongs — of purest gold;</p> <p>The snuffers, basins, dishes for incense, and fire pans — of pure gold. The sockets of the temple, for both the inner doors to the most holy place and the doors of the nave of the temple — of gold.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

v5 — 1 Kgs 7:26

v6 — 1 Kgs 7:38

v8 — 1 Kgs 7:48

v9 — 1 Kgs 6:36

Chapter 5

Solomon brought the dedicated treasures of David into the temple, and the priests carried the ark of the covenant into the most holy place. When the trumpeters and singers praised the LORD in unison, the glory of the LORD filled the house as a cloud.

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| 1 | <i>Thus all the work that Solomon made for the house of the LORD was finished: and Solomon brought in all the things that David his father had dedicated; and the silver, and the gold, and all the instruments, put he among the treasures of the house of God.</i> | Thus all the work that Solomon did for the house of the LORD was finished. And Solomon brought in the things that David his father had dedicated — the silver, the gold, and all the vessels — and put them in the treasuries of the house of God. |
| 2 | <i>Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the fathers of the children of Israel, unto Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion.</i> | Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel and all the heads of the tribes, the leaders of the fathers' houses of the people of Israel, in Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion. |
| 3 | <i>Wherefore all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto the king in the feast which was in the seventh month.</i> | All the men of Israel assembled before the king at the feast that is in the seventh month. |
| 4 | <i>And all the elders of Israel came; and the Levites took up the ark.</i> | All the elders of Israel came, and the Levites took up the ark. |

- 5 *And they brought up the ark, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in the tabernacle, these did the priests and the Levites bring up.* They brought up the ark, the tent of meeting. All the holy vessels that were in the tent; the priests and the Levites brought them up.
- 6 *Also king Solomon, and all the congregation of Israel that were assembled unto him before the ark, sacrificed sheep and oxen, which could not be told nor numbered for multitude.* King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel, who had assembled before him, were before the ark, sacrificing so many sheep and oxen that they could not be counted or numbered.
- 7 *And the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the LORD unto his place, to the oracle of the house, into the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubims:* So the priests brought the ark of the covenant of the LORD to its place, into the inner sanctuary of the house, to the most holy place, underneath the wings of the cherubim.
- 8 *For the cherubims spread forth their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubims covered the ark and the staves thereof above.* The cherubim spread their wings over the place of the ark, so that the cherubim overshadowed the ark and its poles.
- 9 *And they drew out the staves of the ark, that the ends of the staves were seen from the ark before the oracle; but they were not seen without. And there it is unto this day.* The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the holy place before the inner sanctuary. But they could not be seen from outside. And they are there to this day.
- 10 *There was nothing in the ark save the two tables which Moses put therein at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt.* There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets that Moses put there at Horeb, where the LORD made a covenant with the people of Israel when they came out of Egypt.
- 11 *And it came to pass, when the priests were come out of the holy place: (for all the priests that were present were sanctified, and did not then wait by course:* When the priests came out of the holy place (for all the priests who were present had consecrated themselves, without regard to their divisions;

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Also the Levites which were the singers, all of them of Asaph, of Heman, of Jeduthun, with their sons and their brethren, being arrayed in white linen, having cymbals and psalteries and harps, stood at the east end of the altar, and with them an hundred and twenty priests sounding with trumpets:)

All the Levitical singers, Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun, their sons and kinsmen, arrayed in fine linen, with cymbals, harps, and lyres, stood east of the altar with one hundred twenty priests who were trumpeters);
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It came even to pass, as the trumpeters and singers were as one, to make one sound to be heard in praising and thanking the LORD; and when they lifted up their voice with the trumpets and cymbals and instruments of musick, and praised the LORD, saying, For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever: that then the house was filled with a cloud, even the house of the LORD;

It was the duty of the trumpeters and singers to make themselves heard in unison in praise and thanksgiving to the LORD — and when the song was raised, with trumpets and cymbals and other musical instruments, in praise to the LORD, "For He is good, for His mercy endures forever," the house of the LORD was filled with a cloud,
- 14

So that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud: for the glory of the LORD had filled the house of God.

So that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled the house of God.

Words in this chapter:

- Jeduthun** (*jeh-DOO-thun*) — A musical director in David's time — Psalm titles addressed 'to' or 'after' him indicate his musical style.
- ark of the covenant** — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.
- Horeb** (*HOR-eb*) — Another name for Mount Sinai — the mountain where God appeared to Moses in the burning bush and later where Elijah fled from Jezebel.
- Zion** (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Kgs 7:51

v2 — 2 Sam 6:12

v3 — 1 Kgs 8:2; 2 Chr 7:8-10

v12 — 1 Chr 15:24

v13 — Ezra 3:11; 2 Chr 7:3; Jer 33:11; Rev 5:8-14; Isa 52:8

v14 — Ex 40:35; 1 Kgs 8:11; Isa 6:1-4; Rev 15:8; 2 Chr 7:2

Chapter 6

Solomon stood before the altar and prayed his great dedicatory prayer, asking God to hear from heaven whenever His people prayed toward the temple in times of sin, defeat, drought, famine, or captivity.

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| 1 <i>Then said Solomon, The LORD hath said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.</i> | Then Solomon said, "The LORD has said that He would dwell in thick darkness. |
| 2 <i>But I have built an house of habitation for thee, and a place for thy dwelling for ever.</i> | But I have built You a house to dwell in, a place for You to live in forever." |
| 3 <i>And the king turned his face, and blessed the whole congregation of Israel: and all the congregation of Israel stood.</i> | Then the king turned around and blessed all the assembly of Israel, while all the assembly of Israel stood. |
| 4 <i>And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, who hath with his hands fulfilled that which he spake with his mouth to my father David, saying,</i> | He said, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who with His hand has fulfilled what He promised with His mouth to David my father, saying, |
| 5 <i>Since the day that I brought forth my people out of the land of Egypt I chose no city among all the tribes of Israel to build an house in, that my name might be there; neither chose I any man to be a ruler over my people Israel:</i> | 'Since the day that I brought my people out of the land of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel in which to build a house, so that my name might be there. I chose no man as prince over my people Israel; |
| 6 <i>But I have chosen Jerusalem, that my name might be there; and have chosen David to be over my people Israel.</i> | But I have chosen Jerusalem that my name may be there. I have chosen David to be over my people Israel.' |

- 7 *Now it was in the heart of David my father to build an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.* Now it was in the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 8 *But the LORD said to David my father, Forasmuch as it was in thine heart to build an house for my name, thou didst well in that it was in thine heart:* But the LORD said to David my father, 'Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart.
- 9 *Notwithstanding thou shalt not build the house; but thy son which shall come forth out of thy loins, he shall build the house for my name.* Nevertheless, it is not You who shall build the house, but Your son who shall be born to You shall build the house for my name.'
- 10 *The LORD therefore hath performed his word that he hath spoken: for I am risen up in the room of David my father, and am set on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised, and have built the house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.* The LORD has fulfilled His promise that He made. For I have risen in the place of David my father and sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised. I have built the house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 11 *And in it have I put the ark, wherein is the covenant of the LORD, that he made with the children of Israel.* There I have set the ark, in which is the covenant of the LORD that He made with the people of Israel."
- 12 *And he stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands:* Then Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the assembly of Israel and spread out His hands.
- 13 *For Solomon had made a brasen scaffold, of five cubits long, and five cubits broad, and three cubits high, and had set it in the midst of the court: and upon it he stood, and kneeled down upon his knees before all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands toward heaven,* Solomon had made a bronze platform five cubits long, five cubits wide, and three cubits high, and had set it in the court. He stood on it. Then he knelt on his knees in the presence of all the assembly of Israel and spread out his hands toward heaven,

- 14 *And said, O LORD God of Israel, there is no God like thee in the heaven, nor in the earth; which keepest covenant, and shewest mercy unto thy servants, that walk before thee with all their hearts:* And said: "O LORD, God of Israel, there is no God like You, in heaven or on earth, keeping covenant and showing mercy to Your servants who walk before You with all their heart;
- 15 *Thou which hast kept with thy servant David my father that which thou hast promised him; and spakest with thy mouth, and hast fulfilled it with thine hand, as it is this day.* You who have kept with your servant David my father what you declared to him. You spoke with your mouth, and with your hand have fulfilled it this day.
- 16 *Now therefore, O LORD God of Israel, keep with thy servant David my father that which thou hast promised him, saying, There shall not fail thee a man in my sight to sit upon the throne of Israel; yet so that thy children take heed to their way to walk in my law, as thou hast walked before me.* Now therefore, O LORD, God of Israel, keep for Your servant David my father what you have promised him, saying, 'You shall not lack a man to sit before me on the throne of Israel, if only Your sons pay close attention to their way, to walk in my law as You have walked before me.'
- 17 *Now then, O LORD God of Israel, let thy word be verified, which thou hast spoken unto thy servant David.* Now therefore, O LORD, God of Israel, let Your word be confirmed, which You have spoken to Your servant David.
- 18 *But will God in very deed dwell with men on the earth? behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house which I have built!* But will God indeed dwell with man on the earth? heaven and the highest heaven cannot contain You, how much less this house that I have built!
- 19 *Have respect therefore to the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplication, O LORD my God, to hearken unto the cry and the prayer which thy servant prayeth before thee:* Yet have regard to the prayer of Your servant and to His plea, O LORD my God, listening to the cry and to the prayer that Your servant prays before You,

- 20 *That thine eyes may be open upon this house day and night, upon the place whereof thou hast said that thou wouldst put thy name there; to hearken unto the prayer which thy servant prayeth toward this place.* That Your eyes may be open day and night toward this house, the place where You have promised to set Your name, that You may listen to the prayer that Your servant offers toward this place.
- 21 *Hearken therefore unto the supplications of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, which they shall make toward this place: hear thou from thy dwelling place, even from heaven; and when thou hearest, forgive.* Listen to the pleas of Your servant and of Your people Israel, when they pray toward this place. And listen from heaven Your dwelling place, and when You hear, forgive.
- 22 *If a man sin against his neighbour, and an oath be laid upon him to make him swear, and the oath come before thine altar in this house;* If a man sins against his neighbor and is made to take an oath and comes and swears His oath before Your altar in this house,
- 23 *Then hear thou from heaven, and do, and judge thy servants, by requiting the wicked, by recompensing his way upon his own head; and by justifying the righteous, by giving him according to his righteousness.* Then hear from heaven and act and judge Your servants, repaying the guilty by bringing His conduct on His own head, and vindicating the righteous by rewarding him according to his righteousness.
- 24 *And if thy people Israel be put to the worse before the enemy, because they have sinned against thee; and shall return and confess thy name, and pray and make supplication before thee in this house;* If Your people Israel are defeated before the enemy because they have sinned against you. They turn again and acknowledge Your name and pray and plead with You in this house,
- 25 *Then hear thou from the heavens, and forgive the sin of thy people Israel, and bring them again unto the land which thou gavest to them and to their fathers.* Then hear from heaven and forgive the sin of Your people Israel and bring them back to the land that You gave to them and to their fathers.

- 26 *When the heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against thee; yet if they pray toward this place, and confess thy name, and turn from their sin, when thou dost afflict them;* When heaven is shut up and there is no rain because they have sinned against You, if they pray toward this place and acknowledge Your name and turn from their sin, when You afflict them,
- 27 *Then hear thou from heaven, and forgive the sin of thy servants, and of thy people Israel, when thou hast taught them the good way, wherein they should walk; and send rain upon thy land, which thou hast given unto thy people for an inheritance.* Then hear in heaven and forgive the sin of Your servants, Your people Israel, when You teach them the good way in which they should walk, and send rain on Your land, which You have given to Your people as an inheritance.
- 28 *If there be dearth in the land, if there be pestilence, if there be blasting, or mildew, locusts, or caterpillars; if their enemies besiege them in the cities of their land; whatsoever sore or whatsoever sickness there be:* If there is famine in the land, if there is pestilence or blight or mildew or locust or caterpillar, if their enemies besiege them in the cities of their land, or whatever plague or whatever sickness there is,
- 29 *Then what prayer or what supplication soever shall be made of any man, or of all thy people Israel, when every one shall know his own sore and his own grief, and shall spread forth his hands in this house:* Whatever prayer or plea is made by any man or by all Your people Israel, each knowing His own affliction and His own sorrow and stretching out His hands toward this house,
- 30 *Then hear thou from heaven thy dwelling place, and forgive, and render unto every man according unto all his ways, whose heart thou knowest; (for thou only knowest the hearts of the children of men:)* Then hear from heaven Your dwelling place and forgive and render to each one whose heart you know — for you, you alone, know the hearts of the children of man —
- 31 *That they may fear thee, to walk in thy ways, so long as they live in the land which thou gavest unto our fathers.* That they may fear You and walk in Your ways all the days that they live in the land that You gave to our fathers.

- 32 *Moreover concerning the stranger, which is not of thy people Israel, but is come from a far country for thy great name's sake, and thy mighty hand, and thy stretched out arm; if they come and pray in this house;* Likewise, when a foreigner, who is not of Your people Israel, comes from a far country for the sake of Your great name and Your mighty hand and Your outstretched arm, when He comes and prays toward this house,
- 33 *Then hear thou from the heavens, even from thy dwelling place, and do according to all that the stranger calleth to thee for; that all people of the earth may know thy name, and fear thee, as doth thy people Israel, and may know that this house which I have built is called by thy name.* Hear from heaven Your dwelling place and do according to all for which the foreigner calls to You, in order that all the peoples of the earth may know Your name and fear You, as do Your people Israel, and that they may know that this house that I have built is called by Your name.
- 34 *If thy people go out to war against their enemies by the way that thou shalt send them, and they pray unto thee toward this city which thou hast chosen, and the house which I have built for thy name;* If Your people go out to battle against their enemies, by whatever way You shall send them. They pray to You toward this city that You have chosen and the house that I have built for Your name,
- 35 *Then hear thou from the heavens their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.* Then hear from heaven their prayer and their plea, and maintain their cause.
- 36 *If they sin against thee, (for there is no man which sinneth not,) and thou be angry with them, and deliver them over before their enemies, and they carry them away captives unto a land far off or near;* If they sin against You — for there is no one who does not sin — and you are angry with them and give them to an enemy, so that they are carried away captive to a land far or near,
- 37 *Yet if they bethink themselves in the land whither they are carried captive, and turn and pray unto thee in the land of their captivity, saying, We have sinned, we have done amiss, and have dealt wickedly;* Yet if they turn their heart in the land to which they have been carried captive and repent and plead with You in the land of their captivity, saying, 'We have sinned and have acted perversely and wickedly,'

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| 38 <i>If they return to thee with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their captivity, whither they have carried them captives, and pray toward their land, which thou gavest unto their fathers, and toward the city which thou hast chosen, and toward the house which I have built for thy name:</i> | If they repent with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their captivity to which they were carried captive, and pray toward their land, which You gave to their fathers, the city that You have chosen, and the house that I have built for Your name, |
| 39 <i>Then hear thou from the heavens, even from thy dwelling place, their prayer and their supplications, and maintain their cause, and forgive thy people which have sinned against thee.</i> | Then hear from heaven Your dwelling place their prayer and their pleas, and maintain their cause and forgive Your people who have sinned against You. |
| 40 <i>Now, my God, let, I beseech thee, thine eyes be open, and let thine ears be attent unto the prayer that is made in this place.</i> | Now, O my God, let Your eyes be open and Your ears attentive to the prayer of this place. |
| 41 <i>Now therefore arise, O LORD God, into thy resting place, thou, and the ark of thy strength: let thy priests, O LORD God, be clothed with salvation, and let thy saints rejoice in goodness.</i> | Now arise, O LORD God, and go to Your resting place, You and the ark of Your might. Let Your priests, O LORD God, be clothed with salvation, and let Your saints rejoice in Your goodness. |
| 42 <i>O LORD God, turn not away the face of thine anointed: remember the mercies of David thy servant.</i> | O LORD God, do not turn away the face of Your anointed one! Remember Your mercy for David your servant." |

Words in this chapter:

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 18:8-11; Ex 20:21; Lev 16:2

v6 — Ps 132:13; 1 Chr 28:4; 2 Chr 12:13; Ps 78:68-70; Ps 48:1

v11 — 2 Chr 5:10

v13 — 1 Kgs 8:54; Neh 8:4

v14 — Ex 15:11; Deut 7:9; 1 Thess 2:12; Ps 89:28; Luke 1:54-55

v16 — 1 Kgs 2:4

v17 — Jer 11:5

v18 — Isa 66:1; 2 Chr 2:6; Ps 139:7-10

v21 — Mic 7:18; Isa 43:25; Dan 9:19

v30 — 1 Chr 28:9; 1 Sam 16:7

v32 — Isa 56:3-7; Matt 8:10-11; 1 Kgs 8:41-43

v40 — Ps 116:2; 2 Chr 7:15

Chapter 7

Fire came down from heaven and consumed the sacrifices, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple. God appeared to Solomon by night and promised to hear prayer from the temple, but warned that disobedience would bring destruction.

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| <p>¹ <i>Now when Solomon had made an end of praying, the fire came down from heaven, and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices; and the glory of the LORD filled the house.</i></p> | <p>As soon as Solomon finished his prayer, fire came down from heaven and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And the priests could not enter into the house of the LORD, because the glory of the LORD had filled the LORD's house.</i></p> | <p>The priests could not enter the house of the LORD, because the glory of the LORD filled the LORD's house.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And when all the children of Israel saw how the fire came down, and the glory of the LORD upon the house, they bowed themselves with their faces to the ground upon the pavement, and worshipped, and praised the LORD, saying, For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever.</i></p> | <p>When all the people of Israel saw the fire come down and the glory of the LORD on the temple, they bowed down with their faces to the ground on the pavement and worshiped and gave thanks to the LORD, saying, "For He is good, for His mercy endures forever."</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before the LORD.</p> |

- 5 *And king Solomon offered a sacrifice of twenty and two thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep: so the king and all the people dedicated the house of God.* King Solomon offered as a sacrifice twenty-two thousand oxen and one hundred twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the people dedicated the house of God.
- 6 *And the priests waited on their offices: the Levites also with instruments of musick of the LORD, which David the king had made to praise the LORD, because his mercy endureth for ever, when David praised by their ministry; and the priests sounded trumpets before them, and all Israel stood.* The priests stood at their posts; the Levites also, with the instruments for music to the LORD that King David had made for giving thanks to the LORD — for His mercy endures forever — whenever David offered praises by their ministry; opposite them the priests sounded trumpets. All Israel stood.
- 7 *Moreover Solomon hallowed the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD: for there he offered burnt offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings, because the brasen altar which Solomon had made was not able to receive the burnt offerings, and the meat offerings, and the fat.* Solomon consecrated the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD, for there He offered the burnt offerings and the fat of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar that Solomon had made could not hold the burnt offering and the grain offering and the fat.
- 8 *Also at the same time Solomon kept the feast seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great congregation, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt.* At that time Solomon held the feast for seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great assembly, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt.
- 9 *And in the eighth day they made a solemn assembly: for they kept the dedication of the altar seven days, and the feast seven days.* On the eighth day they held a solemn assembly, for they had kept the dedication of the altar seven days and the feast seven days.

- 10 *And on the three and twentieth day of the seventh month he sent the people away into their tents, glad and merry in heart for the goodness that the LORD had shewed unto David, and to Solomon, and to Israel his people.* On the twenty-third day of the seventh month He sent the people away to their homes, joyful and glad of heart for the goodness that the LORD had shown to David and to Solomon and to Israel his people.
- 11 *Thus Solomon finished the house of the LORD, and the king's house: and all that came into Solomon's heart to make in the house of the LORD, and in his own house, he prosperously effected.* Thus Solomon finished the house of the LORD and the king's house. All that Solomon had planned to do in the house of the LORD and in His own house He successfully accomplished.
- 12 *And the LORD appeared to Solomon by night, and said unto him, I have heard thy prayer, and have chosen this place to myself for an house of sacrifice.* Then the LORD appeared to Solomon in the night and said to him: "I have heard Your prayer and have chosen this place for myself as a house of sacrifice.
- 13 *If I shut up heaven that there be no rain, or if I command the locusts to devour the land, or if I send pestilence among my people;* When I shut up the heavens so that there is no rain, or command the locust to devour the land, or send pestilence among my people,
- 14 *If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin, and will heal their land.* If my people who are called by my name humble themselves, and pray and seek my face and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven and will forgive their sin and heal their land.
- 15 *Now mine eyes shall be open, and mine ears attent unto the prayer that is made in this place.* Now my eyes will be open and my ears attentive to the prayer that is made in this place.
- 16 *For now have I chosen and sanctified this house, that my name may be there for ever: and mine eyes and mine heart shall be there perpetually.* For now I have chosen and consecrated this house that my name may be there forever. My eyes and my heart will be there for all time.

- 17 *And as for thee, if thou wilt walk before me, as David thy father walked, and do according to all that I have commanded thee, and shalt observe my statutes and my judgments;* As for you, if you will walk before me as David your father walked, doing according to all that I have commanded you and keeping my statutes and my rules,
- 18 *Then will I stablish the throne of thy kingdom, according as I have covenanted with David thy father, saying, There shall not fail thee a man to be ruler in Israel.* Then I will establish your royal throne, as I covenanted with David your father, saying, 'You shall not lack a man to rule Israel.'
- 19 *But if ye turn away, and forsake my statutes and my commandments, which I have set before you, and shall go and serve other gods, and worship them;* But if you turn aside and forsake my statutes and my commandments that I have set before you, and go and serve other gods and worship them,
- 20 *Then will I pluck them up by the roots out of my land which I have given them; and this house, which I have sanctified for my name, will I cast out of my sight, and will make it to be a proverb and a byword among all nations.* Then I will pluck you up from my land that I have given you, and this house that I have consecrated for my name, I will cast out of my sight. I will make it a proverb and a byword among all peoples.
- 21 *And this house, which is high, shall be an astonishment to every one that passeth by it; so that he shall say, Why hath the LORD done thus unto this land, and unto this house?* This house that was exalted, everyone passing by will be astonished and say, 'Why has the LORD done thus to this land and to this house?'
- 22 *And it shall be answered, Because they forsook the LORD God of their fathers, which brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, and laid hold on other gods, and worshipped them, and served them: therefore hath he brought all this evil upon them.* Then they will say, 'Because they abandoned the LORD, the God of their fathers who brought them out of the land of Egypt, and laid hold on other gods and worshiped them and served them. Therefore He has brought all this disaster on them.' "

Words in this chapter:

- peace offering** — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.
- meat** — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Kgs 18:38; 1 Chr 21:26; Lev 9:23-24; 1 Kgs 18:24; Ezek 44:4
- v2** — Rev 15:8
- v3** — 2 Chr 5:13; 2 Chr 20:21; Heb 7:24-25; Luke 1:50
- v5** — John 10:22
- v11** — 1 Kgs 9:1-9
- v13** — 2 Chr 6:26-28; Deut 11:17; Rev 11:6; Rev 3:7; 2 Sam 24:13-15
- v14** — Lam 3:40-41; Isa 55:6-7; Jas 4:9-10; Prov 28:13; 2 Chr 6:37-39
- v15** — 1 Pet 3:12; 2 Chr 6:40; Neh 1:6; 2 Chr 6:20; Deut 11:12
- v16** — 2 Chr 7:15; 2 Chr 7:12; 2 Chr 6:5-6; 1 Kgs 9:3; 2 Chr 6:20
- v18** — 2 Chr 6:16
- v19** — Deut 28:15; Lev 26:14
- v20** — Deut 28:37; 2 Kgs 17:20

Chapter 8

After twenty years of building the temple and his own palace, Solomon rebuilt cities, established forced labor from the remaining Canaanite peoples, and organized the priestly and Levitical divisions for worship.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass at the end of twenty years, wherein Solomon had built the house of the LORD, and his own house,</i> | At the end of twenty years, in which Solomon had built the house of the LORD and His own house, |
| 2 | <i>That the cities which Hiram had restored to Solomon, Solomon built them, and caused the children of Israel to dwell there.</i> | Solomon rebuilt the cities that Hiram had given to him, and settled the people of Israel in them. |
| 3 | <i>And Solomon went to Hamathzobah, and prevailed against it.</i> | Solomon went to Hamath-zobah and captured it. |
| 4 | <i>And he built Tadmor in the wilderness, and all the store cities, which he built in Hamath.</i> | He built Tadmor in the wilderness and all the store cities that he built in Hamath. |

- 5 *Also he built Bethhoron the upper, and Bethhoron the nether, fenced cities, with walls, gates, and bars;* He also built Upper Beth-horon and Lower Beth-horon, fortified cities with walls, gates, and bars,
- 6 *And Baalath, and all the store cities that Solomon had, and all the chariot cities, and the cities of the horsemen, and all that Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and throughout all the land of his dominion.* Baalath. All the store cities that Solomon had and all the cities for his chariots and the cities for his horsemen, and whatever Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion.
- 7 *As for all the people that were left of the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, which were not of Israel,* As for all the people who were left of the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were not of Israel,
- 8 *But of their children, who were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel consumed not, them did Solomon make to pay tribute until this day.* From their descendants who were left after them in the land, whom the people of Israel had not destroyed — these Solomon drafted as forced labor, and so they are to this day.
- 9 *But of the children of Israel did Solomon make no servants for his work; but they were men of war, and chief of his captains, and captains of his chariots and horsemen.* But Solomon did not make the people of Israel servants for his work; they were soldiers. His officers, the commanders of his chariots. His horsemen.
- 10 *And these were the chief of king Solomon's officers, even two hundred and fifty, that bare rule over the people.* These were the chief officers of King Solomon, two hundred and fifty, who exercised authority over the people.

- 11 *And Solomon brought up the daughter of Pharaoh out of the city of David unto the house that he had built for her: for he said, My wife shall not dwell in the house of David king of Israel, because the places are holy, whereunto the ark of the LORD hath come.* Solomon brought Pharaoh's daughter up from the city of David to the house that he had built for her, for he said, "My wife shall not live in the house of David king of Israel, for the places to which the ark of the LORD has come are holy."
- 12 *Then Solomon offered burnt offerings unto the LORD on the altar of the LORD, which he had built before the porch,* Then Solomon offered up burnt offerings to the LORD on the altar of the LORD that He had built before the vestibule,
- 13 *Even after a certain rate every day, offering according to the commandment of Moses, on the sabbaths, and on the new moons, and on the solemn feasts, three times in the year, even in the feast of unleavened bread, and in the feast of weeks, and in the feast of tabernacles.* As the duty of each day required, offering according to the commandment of Moses for the Sabbaths, the new moons, and the three annual feasts — the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the Feast of Weeks, and the Feast of Booths.
- 14 *And he appointed, according to the order of David his father, the courses of the priests to their service, and the Levites to their charges, to praise and minister before the priests, as the duty of every day required: the porters also by their courses at every gate: for so had David the man of God commanded.* According to the ruling of David his father, he appointed the divisions of the priests for their service, and the Levites for their offices of praise and ministry before the priests as the duty of every day required, and the gatekeepers in their divisions at each gate, for so David the man of God had commanded.
- 15 *And they departed not from the commandment of the king unto the priests and Levites concerning any matter, or concerning the treasures.* They did not turn aside from what the king had commanded the priests and Levites concerning any matter or concerning the treasures.

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| <p>16 <i>Now all the work of Solomon was prepared unto the day of the foundation of the house of the LORD, and until it was finished. So the house of the LORD was perfected.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Then went Solomon to Eziongeber, and to Eloth, at the sea side in the land of Edom.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And Hiram sent him by the hands of his servants ships, and servants that had knowledge of the sea; and they went with the servants of Solomon to Ophir, and took thence four hundred and fifty talents of gold, and brought them to king Solomon.</i></p> | <p>Thus all the work of Solomon was carried out from the day the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid until it was finished. So the house of the LORD was completed.</p> <p>Then Solomon went to Ezion-geber and Eloth on the shore of the sea, in the land of Edom.</p> <p>Hiram sent him by his servants ships and servants familiar with the sea. They went to Ophir together with Solomon's servants and brought from there four hundred fifty talents of gold and brought it to King Solomon.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Feast of Tabernacles — Also called the Feast of Booths — a seven-day harvest festival where Israel lived in temporary shelters, remembering the wilderness wandering.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Hivites (*HY-vytes*) — One of the Canaanite peoples Israel encountered in the Promised Land — the Gibeonites were Hivites who tricked Joshua into a peace treaty.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v11 — 1 Kgs 3:1; 1 Kgs 7:8; 1 Kgs 9:24

v12 — 2 Chr 4:1

v13 — Deut 16:16; Ex 29:38-42

Chapter 9

The queen of Sheba visited Solomon and was overwhelmed by his wisdom and splendor. The chapter records Solomon's immense wealth, his throne of ivory and gold, and his death after forty years of reign.

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| 1 | <i>And when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon, she came to prove Solomon with hard questions at Jerusalem, with a very great company, and camels that bare spices, and gold in abundance, and precious stones: and when she was come to Solomon, she communed with him of all that was in her heart.</i> | Now when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon, she came to Jerusalem to test him with hard questions, with a very great retinue and camels bearing spices and very much gold and precious stones. And when she came to Solomon, she told him all that was on her mind. |
| 2 | <i>And Solomon told her all her questions: and there was nothing hid from Solomon which he told her not.</i> | Solomon answered all her questions. There was nothing hidden from Solomon that he could not explain to her. |
| 3 | <i>And when the queen of Sheba had seen the wisdom of Solomon, and the house that he had built,</i> | When the queen of Sheba had seen the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had built, |
| 4 | <i>And the meat of his table, and the sitting of his servants, and the attendance of his ministers, and their apparel; his cupbearers also, and their apparel; and his ascent by which he went up into the house of the LORD; there was no more spirit in her.</i> | The food of His table, the seating of His officials, the attendance of His servants, their clothing, his cupbearers and their clothing, and His ascent by which He went up to the house of the LORD — there was no more spirit in her. |
| 5 | <i>And she said to the king, It was a true report which I heard in mine own land of thine acts, and of thy wisdom:</i> | She said to the king, "The report was true that I heard in my own land of your words and of your wisdom, |

- 6 *Howbeit I believed not their words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the one half of the greatness of thy wisdom was not told me: for thou exceedest the fame that I heard.* But I did not believe the reports until I came and my own eyes had seen it. And half the greatness of your wisdom was not told me; you surpass the report that I heard.
- 7 *Happy are thy men, and happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and hear thy wisdom.* Happy are your men! Happy are your servants, who continually stand before you and hear your wisdom!
- 8 *Blessed be the LORD thy God, which delighted in thee to set thee on his throne, to be king for the LORD thy God: because thy God loved Israel, to establish them for ever, therefore made he thee king over them, to do judgment and justice.* Blessed be the LORD Your God, Who has delighted in You and set You on His throne as king for the LORD Your God! Because Your God loved Israel and would establish them forever, He has made You king over them, that You may execute justice and righteousness."
- 9 *And she gave the king an hundred and twenty talents of gold, and of spices great abundance, and precious stones: neither was there any such spice as the queen of Sheba gave king Solomon.* Then she gave the king one hundred twenty talents of gold, and a very great quantity of spices and precious stones. There were no spices such as those that the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon.
- 10 *And the servants also of Hiram, and the servants of Solomon, which brought gold from Ophir, brought algum trees and precious stones.* Moreover, the servants of Hiram and the servants of Solomon, who brought gold from Ophir, brought algum wood and precious stones.
- 11 *And the king made of the algum trees terraces to the house of the LORD, and to the king's palace, and harps and psalteries for singers: and there were none such seen before in the land of Judah.* The king made from the algum wood steps for the house of the LORD and for the king's palace, lyres also and harps for the singers. There was never seen the like of them before in the land of Judah.

- 12 *And king Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatsoever she asked, beside that which she had brought unto the king. So she turned, and went away to her own land, she and her servants.* King Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all that she desired, whatever she asked, besides what she had brought to the king. So she turned and went back to her own land with her servants.
- 13 *Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred and threescore and six talents of gold;* Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred sixty-six talents of gold,
- 14 *Beside that which chapmen and merchants brought. And all the kings of Arabia and governors of the country brought gold and silver to Solomon.* Besides that which the traders and merchants brought. And all the kings of Arabia and the governors of the land brought gold and silver to Solomon.
- 15 *And king Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: six hundred shekels of beaten gold went to one target.* King Solomon made two hundred large shields of beaten gold; six hundred shekels of beaten gold went into each shield.
- 16 *And three hundred shields made he of beaten gold: three hundred shekels of gold went to one shield. And the king put them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.* He made three hundred shields of beaten gold; three hundred shekels of gold went into each shield. And the king put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.
- 17 *Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with pure gold.* The king also made a great ivory throne and overlaid it with pure gold.
- 18 *And there were six steps to the throne, with a footstool of gold, which were fastened to the throne, and stays on each side of the sitting place, and two lions standing by the stays:* The throne had six steps and a footstool of gold, which were attached to the throne, and on each side of the seat were armrests and two lions standing beside the armrests,
- 19 *And twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other upon the six steps. There was not the like made in any kingdom.* While twelve lions stood there, one on each end of a step on the six steps. Nothing like it was ever made for any kingdom.

- 20 *And all the drinking vessels of king Solomon were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were of pure gold: none were of silver; it was not any thing accounted of in the days of Solomon.* All King Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold. All the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were of pure gold. Silver was not considered as anything in the days of Solomon.
- 21 *For the king's ships went to Tarshish with the servants of Hiram: every three years once came the ships of Tarshish bringing gold, and silver, ivory, and apes, and peacocks.* For the king's ships went to Tarshish with the servants of Hiram. Once every three years the ships of Tarshish used to come bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks.
- 22 *And king Solomon passed all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom.* Thus King Solomon excelled all the kings of the earth in riches and in wisdom.
- 23 *And all the kings of the earth sought the presence of Solomon, to hear his wisdom, that God had put in his heart.* All the kings of the earth sought the presence of Solomon to hear his wisdom, which God had put into his mind.
- 24 *And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and raiment, harness, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year.* Every one of them brought his present: articles of silver and of gold, garments, myrrh, spices, horses, and mules, so much year by year.
- 25 *And Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses and chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen; whom he bestowed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem.* Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses and chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, whom he stationed in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem.
- 26 *And he reigned over all the kings from the river even unto the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt.* He ruled over all the kings from the Euphrates to the land of the Philistines and to the border of Egypt.

27	<i>And the king made silver in Jerusalem as stones, and cedar trees made he as the sycomore trees that are in the low plains in abundance.</i>	The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stone, and cedar as plentiful as the sycamore of the Shephelah.
28	<i>And they brought unto Solomon horses out of Egypt, and out of all lands.</i>	Horses were imported for Solomon from Egypt and from all lands.
29	<i>Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, first and last, are they not written in the book of Nathan the prophet, and in the prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the visions of Iddo the seer against Jeroboam the son of Nebat?</i>	Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, from first to last, are they not written in the history of Nathan the prophet, and in the prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the visions of Iddo the seer concerning Jeroboam the son of Nebat?
30	<i>And Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years.</i>	Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years.
31	<i>And Solomon slept with his fathers, and he was buried in the city of David his father: and Rehoboam his son reigned in his stead.</i>	Solomon slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David his father, and Rehoboam his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 12:42; Luke 11:31
- v8** — 2 Chr 2:11
- v10** — 2 Chr 8:18
- v22** — 2 Chr 1:12
- v25** — 1 Kgs 4:26

v26 — 1 Kgs 4:21; Gen 15:18

v29 — 1 Chr 29:29

v31 — 1 Kgs 2:10

Rehoboam of Judah — 931–913 BC

Chapter 10

Rehoboam went to Shechem where all Israel asked him to lighten the heavy yoke of Solomon; he rejected the elders' counsel and followed the young men's harsh advice. The ten northern tribes refused his rule, and Israel was divided.

- 1

And Rehoboam went to Shechem: for to Shechem were all Israel come to make him king.

Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king.
- 2

And it came to pass, when Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who was in Egypt, whither he had fled from the presence of Solomon the king, heard it, that Jeroboam returned out of Egypt.

When Jeroboam the son of Nebat heard of it — for he was in Egypt, where he had fled from King Solomon — then Jeroboam returned from Egypt.
- 3

And they sent and called him. So Jeroboam and all Israel came and spake to Rehoboam, saying,

They sent and called him. So Jeroboam and all Israel came and spoke to Rehoboam, saying,
- 4

Thy father made our yoke grievous: now therefore ease thou somewhat the grievous servitude of thy father, and his heavy yoke that he put upon us, and we will serve thee.

"Your father made our yoke heavy. Now therefore lighten the hard service of your father and his heavy yoke that he put on us. We will serve you."
- 5

And he said unto them, Come again unto me after three days. And the people departed.

He said to them, "Come to me again in three days." So the people went away.
- 6

And king Rehoboam took counsel with the old men that had stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, saying, What counsel give ye me to return answer to this people?

Then King Rehoboam took counsel with the old men who had stood before Solomon his father while he was yet alive, saying, "How do you advise me to answer this people?"

- 7 *And they spake unto him, saying, If thou be kind to this people, and please them, and speak good words to them, they will be thy servants for ever.* They said to him, "If you will be kind to this people and please them and speak good words to them, they will be your servants forever."
- 8 *But he forsook the counsel which the old men gave him, and took counsel with the young men that were grown up with him, that stood before him.* But he abandoned the counsel that the old men gave him and took counsel with the young men who had grown up with him and stood before him.
- 9 *And he said unto them, What advice give ye that we may return answer to this people, which have spoken to me, saying, Ease somewhat the yoke that thy father did put upon us?* He said to them, "What do you advise that we answer this people who have said to me, 'Lighten the yoke that your father put on us?'"
- 10 *And the young men that were grown up with him spake unto him, saying, Thus shalt thou answer the people that spake unto thee, saying, Thy father made our yoke heavy, but make thou it somewhat lighter for us; thus shalt thou say unto them, My little finger shall be thicker than my father's loins.* The young men who had grown up with him said to him, "Thus shall you speak to the people who said to you, 'Your father made our yoke heavy, but you lighten it for us.' Thus shall you say to them: 'My little finger is thicker than my father's thigh.'
- 11 *For whereas my father put a heavy yoke upon you, I will put more to your yoke: my father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.* Now, whereas my father laid on you a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke. My father disciplined you with whips. But I will discipline you with scorpions.' "
- 12 *So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam on the third day, as the king bade, saying, Come again to me on the third day.* So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king had said, "Come to me again the third day."
- 13 *And the king answered them roughly; and king Rehoboam forsook the counsel of the old men,* The king answered them harshly. King Rehoboam abandoned the counsel of the old men

- 14 *And answered them after the advice of the young men, saying, My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add thereto: my father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.* Answered them as the young men had advised him, saying, "My father made your yoke heavy. But I will add to it. My father disciplined you with whips. But I will discipline you with scorpions."
- 15 *So the king hearkened not unto the people: for the cause was of God, that the LORD might perform his word, which he spake by the hand of Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat.* So the king did not listen to the people, for it was a turn of affairs brought about by God that the LORD might fulfill His word, which He spoke by Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat.
- 16 *And when all Israel saw that the king would not hearken unto them, the people answered the king, saying, What portion have we in David? and we have none inheritance in the son of Jesse: every man to your tents, O Israel: and now, David, see to thine own house. So all Israel went to their tents.* When all Israel saw that the king did not listen to them, the people answered the king, "What portion have we in David? We have no inheritance in the son of Jesse. Each of you to your tents, O Israel! Look now to your own house, David." So all Israel went to their tents.
- 17 *But as for the children of Israel that dwelt in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them.* But Rehoboam reigned over the people of Israel who lived in the cities of Judah.
- 18 *Then king Rehoboam sent Hadoram that was over the tribute; and the children of Israel stoned him with stones, that he died. But king Rehoboam made speed to get him up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem.* Then King Rehoboam sent Hadoram, who was taskmaster over the forced labor, and the people of Israel stoned him to death with stones. And King Rehoboam quickly mounted his chariot to flee to Jerusalem.
- 19 *And Israel rebelled against the house of David unto this day.* So Israel has been in rebellion against the house of David to this day.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Kgs 11:40

v7 — Prov 15:1

v15 — 1 Kgs 11:29-39; 1 Sam 2:25; 2 Chr 25:16-20

v16 — 2 Chr 10:19; 2 Sam 20:1

v18 — 1 Kgs 5:14

Chapter 11

God through the prophet Shemaiah forbade Rehoboam from fighting to reclaim the northern tribes. Rehoboam fortified cities in Judah and Benjamin, and the priests and Levites from the north came south because Jeroboam had rejected them.

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| <p>1 <i>And when Rehoboam was come to Jerusalem, he gathered of the house of Judah and Benjamin an hundred and fourscore thousand chosen men, which were warriors, to fight against Israel, that he might bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam.</i></p> | <p>When Rehoboam came to Jerusalem, he assembled the house of Judah and Benjamin, one hundred eighty thousand chosen warriors, to fight against Israel, to restore the kingdom to Rehoboam.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>But the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah the man of God, saying,</i></p> | <p>But the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah the man of God:</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Speak unto Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all Israel in Judah and Benjamin, saying,</i></p> | <p>"Say to Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all Israel in Judah and Benjamin,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren: return every man to his house: for this thing is done of me. And they obeyed the words of the LORD, and returned from going against Jeroboam.</i></p> | <p>"Thus says the LORD, You shall not go up or fight against Your brothers. Return every man to his home, for this thing is from me.' " So they listened to the word of the LORD and returned and did not go against Jeroboam.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And Rehoboam dwelt in Jerusalem, and built cities for defence in Judah.</i></p> | <p>Rehoboam lived in Jerusalem. He built cities for defense in Judah.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>He built even Bethlehem, and Etam, and Tekoa,</i></p> | <p>He built Bethlehem, Etam, Tekoa,</p> |

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| 7 | <i>And Bethzur, and Shoco, and Adullam,</i> | Beth-zur, Soco, Adullam, |
| 8 | <i>And Gath, and Mareshah, and Ziph,</i> | Gath, Mareshah, Ziph, |
| 9 | <i>And Adoraim, and Lachish, and Azekah,</i> | Adoraim, Lachish, Azekah, |
| 10 | <i>And Zorah, and Aijalon, and Hebron, which are in Judah and in Benjamin fenced cities.</i> | Zorah, Aijalon, and Hebron — fortified cities in Judah and in Benjamin. |
| 11 | <i>And he fortified the strong holds, and put captains in them, and store of victual, and of oil and wine.</i> | He made the fortresses strong, and put commanders in them, and stores of food, oil, and wine. |
| 12 | <i>And in every several city he put shields and spears, and made them exceeding strong, having Judah and Benjamin on his side.</i> | He put shields and spears in all the cities and made them very strong. So he held Judah and Benjamin. |
| 13 | <i>And the priests and the Levites that were in all Israel resorted to him out of all their coasts.</i> | The priests and the Levites who were in all Israel presented themselves to him from all their territories. |
| 14 | <i>For the Levites left their suburbs and their possession, and came to Judah and Jerusalem: for Jeroboam and his sons had cast them off from executing the priest's office unto the LORD:</i> | For the Levites left their common lands and their holdings and came to Judah and Jerusalem, because Jeroboam and his sons cast them out from serving as priests of the LORD, |
| 15 | <i>And he ordained him priests for the high places, and for the devils, and for the calves which he had made.</i> | He appointed His own priests for the high places and for the devils and for the calves that He had made. |
| 16 | <i>And after them out of all the tribes of Israel such as set their hearts to seek the LORD God of Israel came to Jerusalem, to sacrifice unto the LORD God of their fathers.</i> | Those who had set their hearts to seek the LORD God of Israel came after them from all the tribes of Israel to Jerusalem to sacrifice to the LORD, the God of their fathers. |

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| <p>17 <i>So they strengthened the kingdom of Judah, and made Rehoboam the son of Solomon strong, three years: for three years they walked in the way of David and Solomon.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And Rehoboam took him Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the son of David to wife, and Abihail the daughter of Eliab the son of Jesse;</i></p> <p>19 <i>Which bare him children; Jeush, and Shamariah, and Zaham.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And after her he took Maachah the daughter of Absalom; which bare him Abijah, and Attai, and Ziza, and Shelomith.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Rehoboam loved Maachah the daughter of Absalom above all his wives and his concubines: (for he took eighteen wives, and threescore concubines; and begat twenty and eight sons, and threescore daughters.)</i></p> <p>22 <i>And Rehoboam made Abijah the son of Maachah the chief, to be ruler among his brethren: for he thought to make him king.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And he dealt wisely, and dispersed of all his children throughout all the countries of Judah and Benjamin, unto every fenced city: and he gave them victual in abundance. And he desired many wives.</i></p> | <p>They strengthened the kingdom of Judah, and for three years they made Rehoboam the son of Solomon secure, for they walked for three years in the way of David and Solomon.</p> <p>Rehoboam took as his wife Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the son of David and of Abihail the daughter of Eliab the son of Jesse,</p> <p>She bore him sons: Jeush, Shemariah, and Zaham.</p> <p>After her he took Maacah the daughter of Absalom, who bore him Abijah, Attai, Ziza, and Shelomith.</p> <p>Rehoboam loved Maacah the daughter of Absalom above all his wives and concubines — he took eighteen wives and sixty concubines and begat twenty-eight sons and sixty daughters.</p> <p>Rehoboam appointed Abijah the son of Maacah as chief prince among his brothers, for he intended to make him king.</p> <p>He dealt wisely and distributed some of his sons throughout all the districts of Judah and Benjamin, in all the fortified cities. He gave them abundant provisions and procured many wives for them.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Mahalath (MAH-hah-lath) — A Psalm title of uncertain meaning — possibly a tune name, or related to 'sickness' (a lament tune).

Absalom (*AB-sah-lom*) — David's third son — renowned for his beauty; led a rebellion against his father; killed by Joab while hanging by his hair in a tree; his name means 'father of peace.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Hebron (*HEE-bron*) — A city in the hill country of Judah — Abraham buried Sarah here in the cave of Machpelah; David reigned here for seven years before Jerusalem.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Chr 12:15
- v4 — Gen 50:20
- v14 — 2 Chr 13:9
- v16 — 2 Chr 15:9
- v17 — 2 Chr 12:1
- v21 — Judg 8:30; Deut 17:17; 1 Kgs 11:3; 2 Sam 3:2-5; 2 Sam 5:13
- v22 — Deut 21:15-17

Chapter 12

When Rehoboam was established, he and all Israel abandoned the law of the LORD. Shishak king of Egypt invaded with a vast army; the LORD humbled Rehoboam, who repented, so God granted partial deliverance but Judah became Egypt's vassal.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, when Rehoboam had established the kingdom, and had strengthened himself, he forsook the law of the LORD, and all Israel with him.</i> | When the rule of Rehoboam was established and he was strong, he abandoned the law of the LORD, and all Israel with Him. |
| 2 | <i>And it came to pass, that in the fifth year of king Rehoboam Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, because they had transgressed against the LORD,</i> | In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, because they had been unfaithful to the LORD, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem |

- 3 *With twelve hundred chariots, and threescore thousand horsemen: and the people were without number that came with him out of Egypt; the Lubims, the Sukkiims, and the Ethiopians.* With twelve hundred chariots and sixty thousand horsemen. And the people were without number who came with him from Egypt — Libyans, Sukkiim, and Ethiopians.
- 4 *And he took the fenced cities which pertained to Judah, and came to Jerusalem.* He took the fortified cities of Judah and came as far as Jerusalem.
- 5 *Then came Shemaiah the prophet to Rehoboam, and to the princes of Judah, that were gathered together to Jerusalem because of Shishak, and said unto them, Thus saith the LORD, Ye have forsaken me, and therefore have I also left you in the hand of Shishak.* Then Shemaiah the prophet came to Rehoboam and to the princes of Judah, who had gathered at Jerusalem because of Shishak, and said to them, "Thus says the LORD, 'You abandoned me, so I have abandoned You to the hand of Shishak.' "
- 6 *Whereupon the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves; and they said, The LORD is righteous.* Then the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves and said, "The LORD is righteous."
- 7 *And when the LORD saw that they humbled themselves, the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah, saying, They have humbled themselves; therefore I will not destroy them, but I will grant them some deliverance; and my wrath shall not be poured out upon Jerusalem by the hand of Shishak.* When the LORD saw that they humbled themselves, the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah: "They have humbled themselves. I will not destroy them. But I will grant them some deliverance, and my wrath shall not be poured out on Jerusalem by the hand of Shishak.
- 8 *Nevertheless they shall be his servants; that they may know my service, and the service of the kingdoms of the countries.* Nevertheless, they shall be servants to Him, that they may know my service and the service of the kingdoms of the countries."

- 9 *So Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, and took away the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house; he took all: he carried away also the shields of gold which Solomon had made.* So Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem. He took away the treasures of the house of the LORD and the treasures of the king's house. He took everything. He also took away the shields of gold that Solomon had made.
- 10 *And king Rehoboam made shields of brass instead of them, and committed them to the hands of the chief of the guard, that kept the entrance of the king's house.* King Rehoboam made in their place shields of bronze and committed them to the hands of the officers of the guard, who kept the door of the king's house.
- 11 *And when the king entered into the house of the LORD, the guard came and fetched them, and brought them again into the guard chamber.* As often as the king went into the house of the LORD, the guard came and carried them and brought them back to the guardroom.
- 12 *And when he humbled himself, the wrath of the LORD turned from him, that he would not destroy him altogether: and also in Judah things went well.* When He humbled Himself, the wrath of the LORD turned from Him, so as not to make a complete destruction. Moreover, conditions were good in Judah.
- 13 *So king Rehoboam strengthened himself in Jerusalem, and reigned: for Rehoboam was one and forty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess.* So King Rehoboam grew strong in Jerusalem and reigned. Rehoboam was forty-one years old when he began to reign. He reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city that the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel to put His name there. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonite.
- 14 *And he did evil, because he prepared not his heart to seek the LORD.* He did evil, for He did not set His heart to seek the LORD.

- 15

Now the acts of Rehoboam, first and last, are they not written in the book of Shemaiah the prophet, and of Iddo the seer concerning genealogies? And there were wars between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually.
- Now the acts of Rehoboam, from first to last, are they not written in the records of Shemaiah the prophet and of Iddo the seer? There were continual wars between Rehoboam and Jeroboam.
- 16

And Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David: and Abijah his son reigned in his stead.
- Rehoboam slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David, and Abijah his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Chr 11:17; 2 Chr 12:13
- v2 — 1 Kgs 11:40
- v3 — Nah 3:9; 2 Chr 16:8
- v5 — 2 Chr 11:2; 2 Chr 15:2
- v6 — Ex 9:27
- v8 — Deut 28:47-48; Isa 26:13
- v12 — 2 Chr 19:3; 1 Kgs 14:13; 2 Chr 33:12-13; 2 Chr 12:6-7
- v13 — 1 Kgs 14:21
- v14 — 2 Chr 19:3
- v15 — 2 Chr 9:29

Abijah of Judah — 913–911 BC

Chapter 13

Abijah king of Judah went to war against Jeroboam of Israel with an army half the size. Abijah rebuked Israel for forsaking the LORD and the Levitical priesthood; God struck Jeroboam’s forces, and Judah won a great victory.

- 1

Now in the eighteenth year of king Jeroboam began Abijah to reign over Judah.
- In the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam, Abijah began to reign over Judah.

- 2 *He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Michaiah the daughter of Uriel of Gibeah. And there was war between Abijah and Jeroboam.* He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Micaiah the daughter of Uriel of Gibeah. There was war between Abijah and Jeroboam.
- 3 *And Abijah set the battle in array with an army of valiant men of war, even four hundred thousand chosen men: Jeroboam also set the battle in array against him with eight hundred thousand chosen men, being mighty men of valour.* Abijah went into battle with an army of valiant warriors, four hundred thousand chosen men. And Jeroboam drew up his line of battle against him with eight hundred thousand chosen mighty warriors.
- 4 *And Abijah stood up upon mount Zemaraim, which is in mount Ephraim, and said, Hear me, thou Jeroboam, and all Israel;* Then Abijah stood up on Mount Zemaraim that is in the hill country of Ephraim and said, "Hear me, O Jeroboam and all Israel!
- 5 *Ought ye not to know that the LORD God of Israel gave the kingdom over Israel to David for ever, even to him and to his sons by a covenant of salt?* Ought You not to know that the LORD God of Israel gave the kingship over Israel forever to David and his sons by a covenant of salt?
- 6 *Yet Jeroboam the son of Nebat, the servant of Solomon the son of David, is risen up, and hath rebelled against his lord.* Yet Jeroboam the son of Nebat, a servant of Solomon the son of David, rose up and rebelled against his lord,
- 7 *And there are gathered unto him vain men, the children of Belial, and have strengthened themselves against Rehoboam the son of Solomon, when Rehoboam was young and tenderhearted, and could not withstand them.* Certain worthless scoundrels gathered around him and defied Rehoboam the son of Solomon, when Rehoboam was young and irresolute and could not resist them.

- 8 *And now ye think to withstand the kingdom of the LORD in the hand of the sons of David; and ye be a great multitude, and there are with you golden calves, which Jeroboam made you for gods.* Now You think to withstand the kingdom of the LORD in the hand of the sons of David, because you are a great crowd and have with You the golden calves that Jeroboam made you for gods.
- 9 *Have ye not cast out the priests of the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and have made you priests after the manner of the nations of other lands? so that whosoever cometh to consecrate himself with a young bullock and seven rams, the same may be a priest of them that are no gods.* Have You not driven out the priests of the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and made priests for yourselves like the peoples of other lands? Whoever comes for consecration with a young bull or seven rams becomes a priest of what are not gods.
- 10 *But as for us, the LORD is our God, and we have not forsaken him; and the priests, which minister unto the LORD, are the sons of Aaron, and the Levites wait upon their business:* But as for us, the LORD is our God. We have not forsaken Him. We have priests ministering to the LORD Who are sons of Aaron, and Levites for their service.
- 11 *And they burn unto the LORD every morning and every evening burnt sacrifices and sweet incense: the shewbread also set they in order upon the pure table; and the candlestick of gold with the lamps thereof, to burn every evening: for we keep the charge of the LORD our God; but ye have forsaken him.* They offer to the LORD every morning and every evening burnt offerings and incense of sweet spices, set out the bread of the Presence on the pure table, and care for the golden lampstand that its lamps may burn every evening. For we keep the charge of the LORD our God, but You have forsaken Him.
- 12 *And, behold, God himself is with us for our captain, and his priests with sounding trumpets to cry alarm against you. O children of Israel, fight ye not against the LORD God of your fathers; for ye shall not prosper.* God is with us at our head, and His priests with sounding trumpets to cry alarm against You. O sons of Israel, do not fight against the LORD, the God of Your fathers, for You cannot succeed."

- 13 *But Jeroboam caused an ambushment to come about behind them: so they were before Judah, and the ambushment was behind them.* Jeroboam had sent an ambush around to come at them from behind. Thus his troops were in front of Judah, and the ambush was behind them.
- 14 *And when Judah looked back, behold, the battle was before and behind: and they cried unto the LORD, and the priests sounded with the trumpets.* When Judah looked, the battle was in front of and behind them. And they cried to the LORD, and the priests blew the trumpets.
- 15 *Then the men of Judah gave a shout: and as the men of Judah shouted, it came to pass, that God smote Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah.* Then the men of Judah raised the battle shout. And when the men of Judah shouted, God defeated Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah.
- 16 *And the children of Israel fled before Judah: and God delivered them into their hand.* The people of Israel fled before Judah. God gave them into their hand.
- 17 *And Abijah and his people slew them with a great slaughter: so there fell down slain of Israel five hundred thousand chosen men.* Abijah and his people struck them with a great blow, so there fell slain of Israel five hundred thousand chosen men.
- 18 *Thus the children of Israel were brought under at that time, and the children of Judah prevailed, because they relied upon the LORD God of their fathers.* Thus the people of Israel were subdued at that time, and the people of Judah prevailed, because they relied on the LORD, the God of their fathers.
- 19 *And Abijah pursued after Jeroboam, and took cities from him, Bethel with the towns thereof, and Jeshanah with the towns thereof, and Ephraim with the towns thereof.* Abijah pursued Jeroboam and captured cities from him, Bethel with its villages, Jeshanah with its villages, and Ephron with its villages.
- 20 *Neither did Jeroboam recover strength again in the days of Abijah: and the LORD struck him, and he died.* Jeroboam did not recover his power in the days of Abijah. And the LORD struck Him down. He died.

- 21

But Abijah waxed mighty, and married fourteen wives, and begat twenty and two sons, and sixteen daughters.

But Abijah grew mighty. And He took fourteen wives and begat twenty-two sons and sixteen daughters.
- 22

And the rest of the acts of Abijah, and his ways, and his sayings, are written in the story of the prophet Iddo.

The rest of the acts of Abijah, his ways and his sayings, are written in the story of the prophet Iddo.

Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

- v4** — Josh 18:22
- v5** — Num 18:19; Lev 2:13; 2 Sam 7:12-16; Mark 9:49-50; 1 Kgs 8:20
- v6** — 1 Kgs 11:26
- v8** — 1 Kgs 12:28
- v9** — 2 Chr 11:14-15
- v11** — 2 Chr 2:4
- v12** — Acts 5:39
- v14** — 2 Chr 14:11
- v15** — 2 Chr 14:12
- v18** — 2 Chr 14:11; 1 Chr 5:20; Nah 1:7

Asa of Judah — 911–870 BC

Chapter 14

Asa did what was good and right, removing foreign altars and high places and commanding Judah to seek the LORD. When Zerah the Ethiopian came against him with a million men, Asa cried out to the LORD and God routed the Ethiopians.

- 1

So Abijah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa his son reigned in his stead. In his days the land was quiet ten years.

So Abijah slept with his fathers. They buried him in the city of David. And Asa his son reigned in his place. In his days the land had rest for ten years.

- 2

And Asa did that which was good and right in the eyes of the LORD his God:
- Asa did what was good and right in the eyes of the LORD His God.

■ **NAME NOTE** — *Asa* (AY-suh) — "healer" or "physician" — The third king of Judah, who reigned forty-one years and carried out sweeping religious reforms. He removed foreign altars and idols, commanded Judah to seek the LORD, and enjoyed long periods of peace. His early faith was exemplary, though later he relied on foreign alliances rather than God.

- 3

For he took away the altars of the strange gods, and the high places, and brake down the images, and cut down the groves:
- He removed the foreign altars and the high places and broke down the pillars and cut down the groves.
- 4

And commanded Judah to seek the LORD God of their fathers, and to do the law and the commandment.
- Commanded Judah to seek the LORD, the God of their fathers, and to keep the law and the commandment.
- 5

Also he took away out of all the cities of Judah the high places and the images: and the kingdom was quiet before him.
- He also removed from all the cities of Judah the high places and the incense altars. And the kingdom had rest under Him.
- 6

And he built fenced cities in Judah: for the land had rest, and he had no war in those years; because the LORD had given him rest.
- He built fortified cities in Judah, for the land had rest. He had no war in those years, for the LORD gave Him peace.
- 7

Therefore he said unto Judah, Let us build these cities, and make about them walls, and towers, gates, and bars, while the land is yet before us; because we have sought the LORD our God, we have sought him, and he hath given us rest on every side. So they built and prospered.
- He said to Judah, "Let us build these cities and surround them with walls and towers, gates and bars. The land is still ours, because we have sought the LORD our God. We have sought Him. He has given us rest on every side." So they built and prospered.

- 8 *And Asa had an army of men that bare targets and spears, out of Judah three hundred thousand; and out of Benjamin, that bare shields and drew bows, two hundred and fourscore thousand: all these were mighty men of valour.* Asa had an army of three hundred thousand from Judah, armed with large shields and spears, and two hundred eighty thousand men from Benjamin who carried small shields and drew the bow. All these were mighty warriors.
- 9 *And there came out against them Zerah the Ethiopian with an host of a thousand thousand, and three hundred chariots; and came unto Mareshah.* Zerah the Ethiopian came out against them with an army of a million men and three hundred chariots, and came as far as Mareshah.
- 10 *Then Asa went out against him, and they set the battle in array in the valley of Zephathah at Mareshah.* Asa went out to meet him. They drew up their lines of battle in the Valley of Zephathah at Mareshah.
- 11 *And Asa cried unto the LORD his God, and said, LORD, it is nothing with thee to help, whether with many, or with them that have no power: help us, O LORD our God; for we rest on thee, and in thy name we go against this multitude. O LORD, thou art our God; let no man prevail against thee.* Asa cried to the LORD His God, "O LORD, there is none like You to help, between the mighty and the weak. Help us, O LORD our God, for we rely on You, and in Your name we have come against this crowd. O LORD, You are our God; let not man prevail against You."
- 12 *So the LORD smote the Ethiopians before Asa, and before Judah; and the Ethiopians fled.* So the LORD defeated the Ethiopians before Asa and before Judah, and the Ethiopians fled.
- 13 *And Asa and the people that were with him pursued them unto Gerar: and the Ethiopians were overthrown, that they could not recover themselves; for they were destroyed before the LORD, and before his host; and they carried away very much spoil.* Asa and the people who were with him pursued them as far as Gerar, and the Ethiopians fell until none remained alive, for they were broken before the LORD and His army. The men of Judah carried away very much spoil.

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| 14 <i>And they smote all the cities round about Gerar; for the fear of the LORD came upon them: and they spoiled all the cities; for there was exceeding much spoil in them.</i> | They attacked all the cities around Gerar, for the fear of the LORD was upon them. They plundered all the cities, for there was much plunder in them. |
| 15 <i>They smote also the tents of cattle, and carried away sheep and camels in abundance, and returned to Jerusalem.</i> | They also struck down the tents of those who had livestock and carried away sheep in abundance and camels. Then they returned to Jerusalem. |

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Deut 7:5; 2 Kgs 23:14; Ex 34:13
- v5 — 2 Chr 34:4
- v6 — 2 Chr 15:15
- v7 — 1 Pet 3:12
- v9 — 2 Chr 16:8
- v11 — Jer 1:19; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Ps 22:5; Ps 20:7; 2 Chr 13:14
- v12 — 2 Chr 13:15
- v13 — Gen 10:19
- v14 — 2 Chr 17:10; Gen 35:5

Chapter 15

The prophet Azariah met Asa and told him the LORD would be with Judah as long as they sought Him. Asa took courage, removed the idols, repaired the altar of the LORD, and the people entered a covenant to seek God with all their heart.

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| 1 <i>And the Spirit of God came upon Azariah the son of Oded:</i> | The Spirit of God came upon Azariah the son of Oded, |
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- 2 *And he went out to meet Asa, and said unto him, Hear ye me, Asa, and all Judah and Benjamin; The LORD is with you, while ye be with him; and if ye seek him, he will be found of you; but if ye forsake him, he will forsake you.* He went out to meet Asa and said to him, "Hear me, Asa. All Judah and Benjamin: The LORD is with You while You are with Him. If You seek Him, He will be found by You, but if You forsake Him, He will forsake You.
- 3 *Now for a long season Israel hath been without the true God, and without a teaching priest, and without law.* For a long time Israel was without the true God, and without a teaching priest and without law,
- 4 *But when they in their trouble did turn unto the LORD God of Israel, and sought him, he was found of them.* But when in their distress they turned to the LORD, the God of Israel, and sought Him, He was found by them.
- 5 *And in those times there was no peace to him that went out, nor to him that came in, but great vexations were upon all the inhabitants of the countries.* In those times there was no peace to Him who went out or to Him who came in, for great disturbances afflicted all the inhabitants of the lands.
- 6 *And nation was destroyed of nation, and city of city: for God did vex them with all adversity.* They were broken in pieces. Nation was crushed by nation and city by city, for God troubled them with every sort of distress.
- 7 *Be ye strong therefore, and let not your hands be weak: for your work shall be rewarded.* But You, take courage! Do not let Your hands be weak, for Your work shall be rewarded."

- 8 *And when Asa heard these words, and the prophecy of Oded the prophet, he took courage, and put away the abominable idols out of all the land of Judah and Benjamin, and out of the cities which he had taken from mount Ephraim, and renewed the altar of the LORD, that was before the porch of the LORD.* When Asa heard these words, the prophecy of Azariah the son of Oded the prophet, he took courage and put away the detestable idols from all the land of Judah and Benjamin and from the cities that He had captured in the hill country of Ephraim. He repaired the altar of the LORD that was in front of the vestibule of the house of the LORD.
- 9 *And he gathered all Judah and Benjamin, and the strangers with them out of Ephraim and Manasseh, and out of Simeon: for they fell to him out of Israel in abundance, when they saw that the LORD his God was with him.* He gathered all Judah and Benjamin, and those from Ephraim, Manasseh, and Simeon who were living with them, for great numbers had deserted to Him from Israel when they saw that the LORD His God was with Him.
- 10 *So they gathered themselves together at Jerusalem in the third month, in the fifteenth year of the reign of Asa.* They were gathered at Jerusalem in the third month of the fifteenth year of the reign of Asa.
- 11 *And they offered unto the LORD the same time, of the spoil which they had brought, seven hundred oxen and seven thousand sheep.* They sacrificed to the LORD on that day from the spoil that they had brought — seven hundred oxen and seven thousand sheep.
- 12 *And they entered into a covenant to seek the LORD God of Israel with all their heart and with all their soul;* They entered into a covenant to seek the LORD, the God of their fathers, with all their heart and with all their soul,
- 13 *That whosoever would not seek the LORD God of Israel should be put to death, whether small or great, whether man or woman.* But that whoever would not seek the LORD, the God of Israel, should be put to death, whether young or old, man or woman.
- 14 *And they swore unto the LORD with a loud voice, and with shouting, and with trumpets, and with cornets.* They swore an oath to the LORD with a loud voice and with shouting and with trumpets and with horns.

- 15 *And all Judah rejoiced at the oath: for they had sworn with all their heart, and sought him with their whole desire; and he was found of them: and the LORD gave them rest round about.* All Judah rejoiced over the oath, for they had sworn with all their heart and had sought Him with their whole desire. And He was found by them. The LORD gave them rest all around.
- 16 *And also concerning Maachah the mother of Asa the king, he removed her from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove: and Asa cut down her idol, and stamped it, and burnt it at the brook Kidron.* Even Maachah the mother of King Asa, he removed her from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove. Asa cut down her idol and stamped it and burnt it at the brook Kidron.
- 17 *But the high places were not taken away out of Israel: nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect all his days.* But the high places were not taken out of Israel. Nevertheless, the heart of Asa was wholly true all his days.
- 18 *And he brought into the house of God the things that his father had dedicated, and that he himself had dedicated, silver, and gold, and vessels.* He brought into the house of God the sacred gifts of His father and His own sacred gifts — silver, gold, and vessels.
- 19 *And there was no more war unto the five and thirtieth year of the reign of Asa.* There was no more war until the thirty-fifth year of the reign of Asa.

Words in this chapter:

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Chr 24:20; 2 Chr 20:14
v2 — Jas 4:8; 2 Chr 24:20; 2 Chr 15:4; 1 Chr 28:9; Heb 10:38
v3 — Neh 8:9; Lev 10:11; 2 Chr 17:8-9; Jer 10:10
v4 — Isa 55:6; Deut 4:29-30; 2 Chr 15:15
v7 — 1 Cor 15:58; Josh 1:7; Heb 10:35; Josh 1:9; 1 Chr 28:20
v8 — 2 Chr 8:12; 2 Chr 13:19
v9 — 2 Chr 11:16
v12 — Acts 24:14

v13 — Ex 22:20

v15 — 2 Chr 14:7; 2 Chr 15:12

Chapter 16

In his later years Asa made an alliance with Ben-hadad of Syria against Baasha of Israel instead of relying on the LORD. The seer Hanani rebuked him; Asa was angry and imprisoned the prophet, and he died with a disease in his feet.

- | | |
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| <p>1 <i>In the six and thirtieth year of the reign of Asa Baasha king of Israel came up against Judah, and built Ramah, to the intent that he might let none go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Then Asa brought out silver and gold out of the treasures of the house of the LORD and of the king's house, and sent to Benhadad king of Syria, that dwelt at Damascus, saying,</i></p> <p>3 <i>There is a league between me and thee, as there was between my father and thy father: behold, I have sent thee silver and gold; go, break thy league with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And Benhadad hearkened unto king Asa, and sent the captains of his armies against the cities of Israel; and they smote Ijon, and Dan, and Abelmaim, and all the store cities of Naphtali.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And it came to pass, when Baasha heard it, that he left off building of Ramah, and let his work cease.</i></p> | <p>In the thirty-sixth year of the reign of Asa, Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah and built Ramah, that he might permit no one to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.</p> <p>Then Asa took silver and gold from the treasures of the house of the LORD and the king's house and sent them to Ben-hadad king of Syria, who lived in Damascus, saying,</p> <p>"There is a covenant between me and You, as there was between my father and Your father. I am sending You silver and gold. Go, break Your covenant with Baasha king of Israel, that He may withdraw from me."</p> <p>Ben-hadad listened to King Asa and sent the commanders of his armies against the cities of Israel. They struck Ijon, Dan, Abel-maim, and all the store cities of Naphtali.</p> <p>When Baasha heard of it, he stopped building Ramah and put an end to his work.</p> |
|--|--|

- 6 *Then Asa the king took all Judah; and they carried away the stones of Ramah, and the timber thereof, wherewith Baasha was building; and he built therewith Geba and Mizpah.* Then King Asa took all Judah. They carried away the stones of Ramah and its timber with which Baasha had been building, and with them he built Geba and Mizpah.
- 7 *And at that time Hanani the seer came to Asa king of Judah, and said unto him, Because thou hast relied on the king of Syria, and not relied on the LORD thy God, therefore is the host of the king of Syria escaped out of thine hand.* At that time Hanani the seer came to Asa king of Judah and said to him, "Because you relied on the king of Syria, and did not rely on the LORD Your God, the army of the king of Syria has escaped you.
- 8 *Were not the Ethiopians and the Libyims a huge host, with very many chariots and horsemen? yet, because thou didst rely on the LORD, he delivered them into thine hand.* Were not the Ethiopians and the Libyans a huge army with very many chariots and horsemen? Yet because You relied on the LORD, He gave them into Your hand.
- 9 *For the eyes of the LORD run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to shew himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him. Herein thou hast done foolishly: therefore from henceforth thou shalt have wars.* For the eyes of the LORD run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to give strong support to those whose heart is wholly His. You have done foolishly in this, for from now on You will have wars."
- 10 *Then Asa was wroth with the seer, and put him in a prison house; for he was in a rage with him because of this thing. And Asa oppressed some of the people the same time.* Then Asa was angry with the seer and put him in the stocks in prison, for he was in a rage with him because of this. And Asa inflicted cruelties on some of the people at the same time.
- 11 *And, behold, the acts of Asa, first and last, lo, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.* The acts of Asa, from first to last, are written in the Book of the Kings of Judah and Israel.

- 12

And Asa in the thirty and ninth year of his reign was diseased in his feet, until his disease was exceeding great: yet in his disease he sought not to the LORD, but to the physicians.
- In the thirty-ninth year of His reign Asa was diseased in his feet. His disease became severe. Yet even in His disease He did not seek the LORD, but sought help from physicians.
- 13

And Asa slept with his fathers, and died in the one and fortieth year of his reign.
- Asa slept with his fathers and died in the forty-first year of his reign.
- 14

And they buried him in his own sepulchres, which he had made for himself in the city of David, and laid him in the bed which was filled with sweet odours and divers kinds of spices prepared by the apothecaries' art: and they made a very great burning for him.
- They buried him in the tomb that he had cut for himself in the city of David. They laid him on a bier that had been filled with various kinds of spices prepared by the perfumer's art. They made a very great fire in his honor.

Words in this chapter:

- divers** — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.
- Abel** (AY-bel) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.
- Naphtali** (NAF-tah-ly) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Cross-References:

- v7** — 1 Kgs 16:1; 2 Chr 19:2
- v8** — 2 Chr 12:3
- v9** — 1 Pet 3:12; Prov 15:3; Jer 16:17; Prov 5:21; Ps 34:15
- v12** — Jer 17:5; Mark 5:26; 2 Chr 28:22; 1 Chr 10:14; 2 Chr 16:9
- v14** — Gen 50:2; 2 Chr 21:19

Jehoshaphat of Judah — 870–848 BC

Chapter 17

Jehoshaphat strengthened himself against Israel and walked in the ways of the LORD. He sent officials and Levites throughout Judah to teach the people the law, and the fear of the LORD fell on the surrounding kingdoms.

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| 1 | <i>And Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his stead, and strengthened himself against Israel.</i> | Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his place and strengthened himself against Israel. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jehoshaphat** (jeh-HOSH-uh-fat) — "the LORD has judged" — The fourth king of Judah, son of Asa, who reigned twenty-five years. He walked in the ways of the LORD, sent officials to teach the law throughout Judah, and is remembered for his prayer before battle: "We do not know what to do, but our eyes are on You" (2 Chr 20:12).

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| 2 | <i>He placed forces in all the fenced cities of Judah, and set garrisons in the land of Judah, and in the cities of Ephraim, which Asa his father had taken.</i> | He placed forces in all the fortified cities of Judah and set garrisons in the land of Judah and in the cities of Ephraim that Asa his father had captured. |
| 3 | <i>And the LORD was with Jehoshaphat, because he walked in the first ways of his father David, and sought not unto Baalim;</i> | The LORD was with Jehoshaphat, because he walked in the earlier ways of His father David. He did not seek the Baals, |
| 4 | <i>But sought to the LORD God of his father, and walked in his commandments, and not after the doings of Israel.</i> | But sought the God of His father and walked in His commandments, and not according to the practices of Israel. |
| 5 | <i>Therefore the LORD stablished the kingdom in his hand; and all Judah brought to Jehoshaphat presents; and he had riches and honour in abundance.</i> | Therefore the LORD established the kingdom in His hand. And all Judah brought tribute to Jehoshaphat. He had great riches and honor. |
| 6 | <i>And his heart was lifted up in the ways of the LORD: moreover he took away the high places and groves out of Judah.</i> | His heart was courageous in the ways of the LORD. And furthermore, He removed the high places and the groves from Judah. |
| 7 | <i>Also in the third year of his reign he sent to his princes, even to Benhail, and to Obadiah, and to Zechariah, and to Nethaneel, and to Michaiah, to teach in the cities of Judah:</i> | In the third year of His reign He sent His officials, Ben-hail, Obadiah, Zechariah, Nethanel, and Micaiah, to teach in the cities of Judah; |

- 8 *And with them he sent Levites, even Shemaiah, and Nethaniah, and Zebadiah, and Asahel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehonathan, and Adonijah, and Tobijah, and Tobadonijah, Levites; and with them Elishama and Jehoram, priests.* With them the Levites, Shemaiah, Nethaniah, Zebadiah, Asahel, Shemiramoth, Jehonathan, Adonijah, and Tobijah, and Tob-adonijah the Levites. With them Elishama and Jehoram the priests.
- 9 *And they taught in Judah, and had the book of the law of the LORD with them, and went about throughout all the cities of Judah, and taught the people.* They taught in Judah, having the Book of the Law of the LORD with them. They went throughout all the cities of Judah and taught among the people.
- 10 *And the fear of the LORD fell upon all the kingdoms of the lands that were round about Judah, so that they made no war against Jehoshaphat.* The fear of the LORD fell upon all the kingdoms of the lands that were around Judah. They made no war against Jehoshaphat.
- 11 *Also some of the Philistines brought Jehoshaphat presents, and tribute silver; and the Arabians brought him flocks, seven thousand and seven hundred rams, and seven thousand and seven hundred he goats.* Some of the Philistines brought Jehoshaphat presents and silver for tribute, and the Arabians also brought him flocks: seven thousand seven hundred rams and seven thousand seven hundred goats.
- 12 *And Jehoshaphat waxed great exceedingly; and he built in Judah castles, and cities of store.* Jehoshaphat grew steadily greater. He built in Judah fortresses and store cities,
- 13 *And he had much business in the cities of Judah: and the men of war, mighty men of valour, were in Jerusalem.* He had large supplies in the cities of Judah. He had soldiers, mighty warriors, in Jerusalem.
- 14 *And these are the numbers of them according to the house of their fathers: Of Judah, the captains of thousands; Adnah the chief, and with him mighty men of valour three hundred thousand.* This was the muster of them by fathers' houses: From Judah, the commanders of thousands — Adnah the commander, with three hundred thousand mighty warriors;

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| 15 <i>And next to him was Jehohanan the captain, and with him two hundred and fourscore thousand.</i> | Next to him Jehohanan the commander, with two hundred eighty thousand; |
| 16 <i>And next to him was Amasiah the son of Zichri, who willingly offered himself unto the LORD; and with him two hundred thousand mighty men of valour.</i> | Next to Him Amasiah the son of Zichri, a volunteer for the service of the LORD, with two hundred thousand mighty warriors. |
| 17 <i>And of Benjamin; Eliada a mighty man of valour, and with him armed men with bow and shield two hundred thousand.</i> | From Benjamin: Eliada, a mighty warrior, with two hundred thousand men armed with bow and shield; |
| 18 <i>And next to him was Jehozabad, and with him an hundred and fourscore thousand ready prepared for the war.</i> | Next to Him Jehozabad, with one hundred eighty thousand equipped for war. |
| 19 <i>These waited on the king, beside those whom the king put in the fenced cities throughout all Judah.</i> | These were in the service of the king, besides those whom the king had placed in the fortified cities throughout all Judah. |

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Chr 15:8
- v3 — Isa 41:10; 2 Kgs 22:2; 2 Tim 4:22; Gen 39:2-3; Josh 1:9
- v4 — 1 Kgs 12:28
- v5 — 2 Chr 18:1; Matt 6:33; Matt 2:11; Ps 127:1; Job 42:12
- v6 — Hos 14:9
- v7 — 2 Chr 35:3; Eccl 12:9-10; 2 Chr 15:3; Neh 8:7-8
- v10 — 2 Chr 14:14; Prov 16:7; Ex 15:14-16; Ex 34:24; 2 Chr 16:9
- v11 — 2 Chr 26:8; 2 Chr 9:14
- v16 — Judg 5:9

Chapter 18

Jehoshaphat allied with Ahab to attack Ramoth-gilead, despite the warning of the prophet Micaiah that the LORD had decreed Ahab's defeat. Ahab disguised himself in battle but was struck by a random arrow and died.

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| 1 | <i>Now Jehoshaphat had riches and honour in abundance, and joined affinity with Ahab.</i> | Now Jehoshaphat had great riches and honor. He made a marriage alliance with Ahab. |
| 2 | <i>And after certain years he went down to Ahab to Samaria. And Ahab killed sheep and oxen for him in abundance, and for the people that he had with him, and persuaded him to go up with him to Ramothgilead.</i> | After some years he went down to Ahab in Samaria. And Ahab killed sheep and oxen for him in abundance and for the people who were with him, and induced him to go up against Ramoth-gilead. |
| 3 | <i>And Ahab king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat king of Judah, Wilt thou go with me to Ramothgilead? And he answered him, I am as thou art, and my people as thy people; and we will be with thee in the war.</i> | Ahab king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat king of Judah, "Will you go with me to Ramoth-gilead?" He answered him, "I am as you are, my people as your people. We will be with you in the war." |
| 4 | <i>And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Enquire, I pray thee, at the word of the LORD to day.</i> | Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "Inquire first for the word of the LORD." |
| 5 | <i>Therefore the king of Israel gathered together of prophets four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall we go to Ramothgilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for God will deliver it into the king's hand.</i> | Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, four hundred men, and said to them, "Shall we go to battle against Ramoth-gilead, or shall I refrain?" And they said, "Go up, for God will give it into the hand of the king." |
| 6 | <i>But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we might enquire of him?</i> | But Jehoshaphat said, "Is there not here another prophet of the LORD of whom we may inquire?" |

- 7 *And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man, by whom we may enquire of the LORD: but I hate him; for he never prophesied good unto me, but always evil: the same is Micaiah the son of Imla. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so.* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of the LORD, Micaiah the son of Imlah; but I hate Him, for He never prophesies good concerning me, but always evil." And Jehoshaphat said, "Let not the king say so."
- 8 *And the king of Israel called for one of his officers, and said, Fetch quickly Micaiah the son of Imla.* Then the king of Israel summoned an officer and said, "Bring quickly Micaiah the son of Imlah."
- 9 *And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah sat either of them on his throne, clothed in their robes, and they sat in a void place at the entering in of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets prophesied before them.* Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were sitting on their thrones, arrayed in their robes. And they were sitting at the threshing floor at the entrance of the gate of Samaria. All the prophets were prophesying before them.
- 10 *And Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah had made him horns of iron, and said, Thus saith the LORD, With these thou shalt push Syria until they be consumed.* Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made for himself horns of iron and said, "Thus says the LORD, 'With these You shall push the Syrians until they are destroyed.' "
- 11 *And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramothgilead, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the hand of the king.* All the prophets prophesied so and said, "Go up to Ramoth-gilead and triumph. The LORD will give it into the hand of the king."
- 12 *And the messenger that went to call Micaiah spake to him, saying, Behold, the words of the prophets declare good to the king with one assent; let thy word therefore be like one of theirs, and speak thou good.* The messenger who went to summon Micaiah said to him, " the words of the prophets with one accord are favorable to the king. Let your word be like the word of one of them, and speak favorably."

- 13 *And Micaiah said, As the LORD liveth, even what my God saith, that will I speak.* But Micaiah said, "As the LORD lives, what my God says, that I will speak."
- 14 *And when he was come to the king, the king said unto him, Micaiah, shall we go to Ramothgilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And he said, Go ye up, and prosper, and they shall be delivered into your hand.* When he had come to the king, the king said to him, "Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall I refrain?" And he said, "Go up and triumph. They will be given into your hand."
- 15 *And the king said to him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou say nothing but the truth to me in the name of the LORD?* But the king said to him, "How many times shall I make You swear that You speak to me nothing but the truth in the name of the LORD?"
- 16 *Then he said, I did see all Israel scattered upon the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd: and the LORD said, These have no master; let them return therefore every man to his house in peace.* He said, "I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. And the LORD said, 'These have no master; let each return to His home in peace.' "
- 17 *And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, Did I not tell thee that he would not prophesy good unto me, but evil?* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Did I not tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?"
- 18 *Again he said, Therefore hear the word of the LORD; I saw the LORD sitting upon his throne, and all the host of heaven standing on his right hand and on his left.* Micaiah said, "Therefore hear the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on His throne. All the host of heaven standing on His right hand and on His left.
- 19 *And the LORD said, Who shall entice Ahab king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramothgilead? And one spake saying after this manner, and another saying after that manner.* The LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab the king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gilead?' And one said one thing and another said another.

- 20 *Then there came out a spirit, and stood before the LORD, and said, I will entice him. And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith?* Then a spirit came forward and stood before the LORD, saying, 'I will entice Him.' And the LORD said to Him, 'By what means?'
- 21 *And he said, I will go out, and be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And the LORD said, Thou shalt entice him, and thou shalt also prevail: go out, and do even so.* He said, 'I will go out and be a lying spirit in the mouth of all His prophets.' And He said, 'You are to entice Him, and You shall succeed; go out and do so.'
- 22 *Now therefore, behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil against thee.* Now therefore the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouth of these Your prophets. The LORD has declared disaster concerning You."
- 23 *Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and smote Micaiah upon the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?* Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near and struck Micaiah on the cheek and said, "Which way did the Spirit of the LORD go from me to speak to You?"
- 24 *And Micaiah said, Behold, thou shalt see on that day when thou shalt go into an inner chamber to hide thyself.* Micaiah said, " you shall see on that day when You go into an inner chamber to hide Yourself."
- 25 *Then the king of Israel said, Take ye Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son;* The king of Israel said, "Seize Micaiah and take him back to Amon the governor of the city and to Joash the king's son,
- 26 *And say, Thus saith the king, Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I return in peace.* Say, "Thus says the king, Put this man in prison and feed him with meager rations of bread and water until I return in peace.' "
- 27 *And Micaiah said, If thou certainly return in peace, then hath not the LORD spoken by me. And he said, Harken, all ye people.* Micaiah said, "If You return in peace, the LORD has not spoken by me." And He said, "Hear, all You peoples!"

- 28 *So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramothgilead.* So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead.
- 29 *And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and will enter into the battle; but put thou on thy robes. So the king of Israel disguised himself; and they went to the battle.* The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will disguise myself and go into battle, but you wear your robes." So the king of Israel disguised himself. They went into battle.
- 30 *Now the king of Syria had commanded the captains of the chariots that were with him, saying, Fight ye not with small or great, save only with the king of Israel.* Now the king of Syria had commanded the captains of his chariots, "Fight with neither small nor great, but only with the king of Israel."
- 31 *And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, It is the king of Israel. Therefore they compassed about him to fight: but Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him; and God moved them to depart from him.* When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, "It is the king of Israel." So they turned to fight against Him. And Jehoshaphat cried out. The LORD helped Him; God drew them away from Him.
- 32 *For it came to pass, that, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back again from pursuing him.* For as soon as the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him.
- 33 *And a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between the joints of the harness: therefore he said to his chariot man, Turn thine hand, that thou mayest carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.* But a certain man drew his bow at random and struck the king of Israel between the scale armor and the breastplate. Therefore he said to the driver of his chariot, "Turn around and carry me out of the battle, for I am wounded."

- 34 *And the battle increased that day: howbeit the king of Israel stayed himself up in his chariot against the Syrians until the even: and about the time of the sun going down he died.* The battle continued that day, and the king of Israel was propped up in his chariot facing the Syrians until evening. Then at sunset he died.
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Words in this chapter:

breastplate — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.

Ahab (*AY-hab*) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Chr 17:5

v4 — Jer 21:2

v13 — Num 22:35

v18 — Dan 7:9

v23 — Mark 14:65

v26 — 2 Chr 16:10

v31 — 2 Chr 13:14

Chapter 19

The seer Jehu rebuked Jehoshaphat for helping Ahab, but acknowledged good in him.

Jehoshaphat appointed judges throughout Judah and in Jerusalem, charging them to judge faithfully in the fear of the LORD.

- 1 *And Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned to his house in peace to Jerusalem.* Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned in safety to his house in Jerusalem.

- 2 *And Jehu the son of Hanani the seer went out to meet him, and said to king Jehoshaphat, Shouldest thou help the ungodly, and love them that hate the LORD? therefore is wrath upon thee from before the LORD.* But Jehu the son of Hanani the seer went out to meet him and said to King Jehoshaphat, "Should you help the wicked and love those who hate the LORD? Because of this, wrath has gone out against You from the LORD.
- 3 *Nevertheless there are good things found in thee, in that thou hast taken away the groves out of the land, and hast prepared thine heart to seek God.* Nevertheless, some good is found in You, for You cut down the groves out of the land and have set Your heart to seek God."
- 4 *And Jehoshaphat dwelt at Jerusalem: and he went out again through the people from Beersheba to mount Ephraim, and brought them back unto the LORD God of their fathers.* Jehoshaphat lived at Jerusalem. And he went out again among the people, from Beersheba to the hill country of Ephraim, and brought them back to the LORD, the God of their fathers.
- 5 *And he set judges in the land throughout all the fenced cities of Judah, city by city,* He appointed judges in the land in all the fortified cities of Judah, city by city,
- 6 *And said to the judges, Take heed what ye do: for ye judge not for man, but for the LORD, who is with you in the judgment.* Said to the judges, "Consider what You do, for You judge not for man but for the LORD. He is with You in giving judgment.
- 7 *Wherefore now let the fear of the LORD be upon you; take heed and do it: for there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons, nor taking of gifts.* Now then, let the fear of the LORD be upon You. Be careful what You do, for there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, or respect of persons, or taking of gifts."
- 8 *Moreover in Jerusalem did Jehoshaphat set of the Levites, and of the priests, and of the chief of the fathers of Israel, for the judgment of the LORD, and for controversies, when they returned to Jerusalem.* Moreover, in Jerusalem Jehoshaphat appointed certain Levites and priests and heads of fathers' houses of Israel, to give judgment for the LORD and to decide disputed cases. They had their seat at Jerusalem.

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| <p>9 <i>And he charged them, saying, Thus shall ye do in the fear of the LORD, faithfully, and with a perfect heart.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And what cause soever shall come to you of your brethren that dwell in their cities, between blood and blood, between law and commandment, statutes and judgments, ye shall even warn them that they trespass not against the LORD, and so wrath come upon you, and upon your brethren: this do, and ye shall not trespass.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And, behold, Amariah the chief priest is over you in all matters of the LORD; and Zebadiah the son of Ishmael, the ruler of the house of Judah, for all the king's matters: also the Levites shall be officers before you. Deal courageously, and the LORD shall be with the good.</i></p> | <p>He charged them: "Thus You shall do in the fear of the LORD, in faithfulness and with Your whole heart:</p> <p>Whenever a case comes to You from Your brothers who live in their cities, concerning bloodshed, law or commandment, statutes or rules, You shall warn them, that they may not incur guilt before the LORD and wrath may not come upon You and Your brothers. Thus You shall do, and You will not incur guilt.</p> <p>Amariah the chief priest is over You in all matters of the LORD, and Zebadiah the son of Ishmael, the ruler of the house of Judah, for all the king's matters. The Levites will serve you as officers. Deal courageously, and may the LORD be with the upright!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ishmael (*ISH-mee-el*) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 139:21-22; 2 John 1:10-11; 2 Chr 18:3; Eph 5:11; Jas 4:4
v3 — 2 Chr 12:12; 1 Kgs 14:13; Ezra 7:10
v6 — Deut 1:17; Lev 19:15; Eccl 5:8
v7 — Deut 32:4; Gen 18:25; Rom 2:11; Deut 10:17-18; Col 3:25

Chapter 20

The Moabites, Ammonites, and Meunites invaded Judah; Jehoshaphat proclaimed a fast and prayed before all the people. The LORD told them the battle was His; Judah went out singing praise, and God set the invaders against one another so that none escaped.

- 1 *It came to pass after this also, that the children of Moab, and the children of Ammon, and with them other beside the Ammonites, came against Jehoshaphat to battle.* After this the Moabites and Ammonites, and with them some of the Meunites, came against Jehoshaphat for battle.
- 2 *Then there came some that told Jehoshaphat, saying, There cometh a great multitude against thee from beyond the sea on this side Syria; and, behold, they be in Hazazontamar, which is Engedi.* Some men came and told Jehoshaphat, "A great crowd is coming against you from Edom, from beyond the sea. They are in Hazazon-tamar" (that is, En-gedi).
- 3 *And Jehoshaphat feared, and set himself to seek the LORD, and proclaimed a fast throughout all Judah.* Then Jehoshaphat was afraid and set his face to seek the LORD and proclaimed a fast throughout all Judah.
- 4 *And Judah gathered themselves together, to ask help of the LORD: even out of all the cities of Judah they came to seek the LORD.* Judah assembled to seek help from the LORD; from all the cities of Judah they came to seek the LORD.
- 5 *And Jehoshaphat stood in the congregation of Judah and Jerusalem, in the house of the LORD, before the new court,* Jehoshaphat stood in the assembly of Judah and Jerusalem, in the house of the LORD, before the new court,
- 6 *And said, O LORD God of our fathers, art not thou God in heaven? and rulest not thou over all the kingdoms of the heathen? and in thine hand is there not power and might, so that none is able to withstand thee?* Said, "O LORD, God of our fathers, are You not God in heaven? You rule over all the kingdoms of the nations. In your hand are power and might, so that none is able to withstand You.
- 7 *Art not thou our God, who didst drive out the inhabitants of this land before thy people Israel, and gavest it to the seed of Abraham thy friend for ever?* Did you not, our God, drive out the inhabitants of this land before your people Israel and give it forever to the descendants of Abraham your friend?

- 8 *And they dwelt therein, and have built thee a sanctuary therein for thy name, saying,* They have lived in it and have built for you in it a sanctuary for your name, saying,
- 9 *If, when evil cometh upon us, as the sword, judgment, or pestilence, or famine, we stand before this house, and in thy presence, (for thy name is in this house,) and cry unto thee in our affliction, then thou wilt hear and help.* 'If disaster comes upon us, the sword, judgment, or pestilence, or famine, we will stand before this house and before you — for your name is in this house — and cry out to you in our affliction, and you will hear and save.'
- 10 *And now, behold, the children of Ammon and Moab and mount Seir, whom thou wouldest not let Israel invade, when they came out of the land of Egypt, but they turned from them, and destroyed them not;* Now the men of Ammon and Moab and Mount Seir, whom you would not let Israel invade when they came from the land of Egypt, and whom they avoided and did not destroy —
- 11 *Behold, I say, how they reward us, to come to cast us out of thy possession, which thou hast given us to inherit.* They reward us by coming to drive us out of your possession, which you have given us to inherit.
- 12 *O our God, wilt thou not judge them? for we have no might against this great company that cometh against us; neither know we what to do: but our eyes are upon thee.* O our God, will you not execute judgment on them? For we are powerless against this great horde that is coming against us. We do not know what to do, but our eyes are on you."
- 13 *And all Judah stood before the LORD, with their little ones, their wives, and their children.* Meanwhile all Judah stood before the LORD, with their little ones, their wives, and their children.
- 14 *Then upon Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah, a Levite of the sons of Asaph, came the Spirit of the LORD in the midst of the congregation;* The Spirit of the LORD came upon Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, son of Benaiah, son of Jeiel, son of Mattaniah, a Levite of the sons of Asaph, in the midst of the assembly.

- 15 *And he said, Hearken ye, all Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem, and thou king Jehoshaphat, Thus saith the LORD unto you, Be not afraid nor dismayed by reason of this great multitude; for the battle is not yours, but God's.* He said, "Listen, all Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem and King Jehoshaphat: Thus says the LORD to You, 'Do not be afraid and do not be dismayed at this great horde, for the battle is not Yours but God's.
- 16 *To morrow go ye down against them: behold, they come up by the cliff of Ziz; and ye shall find them at the end of the brook, before the wilderness of Jeruel.* Tomorrow go down against them. They will come up by the ascent of Ziz. You will find them at the end of the valley, east of the wilderness of Jeruel.
- 17 *Ye shall not need to fight in this battle: set yourselves, stand ye still, and see the salvation of the LORD with you, O Judah and Jerusalem: fear not, nor be dismayed; to morrow go out against them: for the LORD will be with you.* You will not need to fight in this battle. Stand firm, hold Your position, and see the salvation of the LORD on Your behalf, O Judah and Jerusalem. Do not be afraid and do not be dismayed. Tomorrow go out against them. The LORD will be with You.' "
- 18 *And Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his face to the ground: and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem fell before the LORD, worshipping the LORD.* Then Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his face to the ground. All Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem fell down before the LORD, worshipping the LORD.
- 19 *And the Levites, of the children of the Kohathites, and of the children of the Korhites, stood up to praise the LORD God of Israel with a loud voice on high.* The Levites, of the Kohathites and the Korahites, stood up to praise the LORD, the God of Israel, with a very loud voice.

- 20 *And they rose early in the morning, and went forth into the wilderness of Tekoa: and as they went forth, Jehoshaphat stood and said, Hear me, O Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem; Believe in the LORD your God, so shall ye be established; believe his prophets, so shall ye prosper.* They rose early in the morning and went out into the wilderness of Tekoa. And when they went out, Jehoshaphat stood and said, "Hear me, Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem! Believe in the LORD Your God, and You will be established; believe His prophets, and You will succeed."
- 21 *And when he had consulted with the people, he appointed singers unto the LORD, and that should praise the beauty of holiness, as they went out before the army, and to say, Praise the LORD; for his mercy endureth for ever.* When He had taken counsel with the people, he appointed those who were to sing to the LORD and praise Him in holy attire, as they went before the army, and say, "Give thanks to the LORD, for His mercy endures forever."
- 22 *And when they began to sing and to praise, the LORD set ambushments against the children of Ammon, Moab, and mount Seir, which were come against Judah; and they were smitten.* When they began to sing and praise, the LORD set an ambush against the men of Ammon, Moab, and Mount Seir, who had come against Judah, so that they were routed.
- 23 *For the children of Ammon and Moab stood up against the inhabitants of mount Seir, utterly to slay and destroy them: and when they had made an end of the inhabitants of Seir, every one helped to destroy another.* For the men of Ammon and Moab rose against the inhabitants of Mount Seir, devoting them to destruction, and when they had made an end of the inhabitants of Seir, they all helped to destroy one another.
- 24 *And when Judah came toward the watch tower in the wilderness, they looked unto the multitude, and, behold, they were dead bodies fallen to the earth, and none escaped.* When Judah came to the watchtower of the wilderness, they looked toward the horde, and there were dead bodies lying on the ground; none had escaped.

- 25 *And when Jehoshaphat and his people came to take away the spoil of them, they found among them in abundance both riches with the dead bodies, and precious jewels, which they stripped off for themselves, more than they could carry away: and they were three days in gathering of the spoil, it was so much.* When Jehoshaphat and his people came to take their spoil, they found among them, in great amounts, goods, clothing, and precious things, which they took for themselves until they could carry no more. They were three days in taking the spoil, it was so much.
- 26 *And on the fourth day they assembled themselves in the valley of Berachah; for there they blessed the LORD: therefore the name of the same place was called, The valley of Berachah, unto this day.* On the fourth day they assembled in the Valley of Beracah, for there they blessed the LORD. Therefore the name of that place has been called the Valley of Beracah to this day.
- 27 *Then they returned, every man of Judah and Jerusalem, and Jehoshaphat in the forefront of them, to go again to Jerusalem with joy: for the LORD had made them to rejoice over their enemies.* Then all the men of Judah and Jerusalem, with Jehoshaphat at their head, returned to Jerusalem with joy, for the LORD had made them rejoice over their enemies.
- 28 *And they came to Jerusalem with psalteries and harps and trumpets unto the house of the LORD.* They came to Jerusalem with harps and lyres and trumpets, to the house of the LORD.
- 29 *And the fear of God was on all the kingdoms of those countries, when they had heard that the LORD fought against the enemies of Israel.* The fear of God came on all the kingdoms of the countries when they heard that the LORD had fought against the enemies of Israel.
- 30 *So the realm of Jehoshaphat was quiet: for his God gave him rest round about.* So the realm of Jehoshaphat was quiet, for his God gave him rest all around.

- 31 *And Jehoshaphat reigned over Judah: he was thirty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.* Thus Jehoshaphat reigned over Judah. He was thirty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.
- 32 *And he walked in the way of Asa his father, and departed not from it, doing that which was right in the sight of the LORD.* He walked in the way of Asa his father and did not turn aside from it, doing what was right in the sight of the LORD.
- 33 *Howbeit the high places were not taken away: for as yet the people had not prepared their hearts unto the God of their fathers.* The high places, however, were not taken away; the people had not yet set their hearts on the God of their fathers.
- 34 *Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of Jehu the son of Hanani, who is mentioned in the book of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, from first to last, are written in the chronicles of Jehu the son of Hanani, which is recorded in the Book of the Kings of Israel.
- 35 *And after this did Jehoshaphat king of Judah join himself with Ahaziah king of Israel, who did very wickedly:* After this Jehoshaphat king of Judah joined with Ahaziah king of Israel, who acted wickedly.
- 36 *And he joined himself with him to make ships to go to Tarshish: and they made the ships in Eziongeber.* He joined him in building ships to go to Tarshish. They built the ships in Ezion-geber.
- 37 *Then Eliezer the son of Dodavah of Mareshah prophesied against Jehoshaphat, saying, Because thou hast joined thyself with Ahaziah, the LORD hath broken thy works. And the ships were broken, that they were not able to go to Tarshish.* Then Eliezer the son of Dodavahu of Mareshah prophesied against Jehoshaphat, saying, "Because you have joined with Ahaziah, the LORD will destroy what You have made." And the ships were wrecked and were not able to go to Tarshish.

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Dan 9:3; 2 Chr 19:3; 1 Sam 7:6; Jonah 3:5-9; Esth 4:16
- v4 — Ps 50:15; Ps 60:10-12
- v6 — Deut 4:39; 1 Chr 29:11-12; Dan 4:17
- v7 — Isa 41:8; Jas 2:23; Gen 12:7; Ps 44:2
- v9 — 2 Chr 6:28-30; 1 Kgs 8:33; 2 Chr 6:20; Ex 20:24
- v10 — Deut 2:4-5; Deut 2:19; Deut 2:9; 2 Chr 20:1; Num 20:17-21
- v12 — Ps 121:1-2; Ps 25:15; Ps 141:8; Ps 123:1-2; Deut 32:36
- v15 — 2 Chr 32:7-8; Deut 31:6; Ex 14:13-14; 1 Sam 17:47; Deut 31:8
- v17 — Ex 14:13-14; 2 Chr 15:2; Isa 41:10; Ps 46:10-11; Matt 28:20
- v18 — Ex 4:31; 2 Chr 7:3; Job 1:20; Gen 24:26
- v20 — Rom 8:31; John 11:40; John 14:1; Luke 16:31; Heb 11:6
- v21 — Ps 107:1; Ps 106:1; 2 Chr 5:13; 1 Chr 16:34; 1 Chr 16:29

Jehoram of Judah — 848–841 BC

Chapter 21

Jehoram killed all his brothers and reigned wickedly, walking in the ways of the house of Ahab. A letter from Elijah prophesied disaster; the Philistines and Arabians invaded, and Jehoram died of a terrible disease with no one's regret.

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| 1 | <i>Now Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. And Jehoram his son reigned in his stead.</i> | Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Jehoram his son reigned in his place. |
| 2 | <i>And he had brethren the sons of Jehoshaphat, Azariah, and Jehiel, and Zechariah, and Azariah, and Michael, and Shephatiah: all these were the sons of Jehoshaphat king of Israel.</i> | He had brothers, the sons of Jehoshaphat: Azariah, Jehiel, Zechariah, Azariah, Michael, and Shephatiah; all these were the sons of Jehoshaphat king of Judah. |

- 3 *And their father gave them great gifts of silver, and of gold, and of precious things, with fenced cities in Judah: but the kingdom gave he to Jehoram; because he was the firstborn.* Their father gave them great gifts of silver, gold, and valuable possessions, together with fortified cities in Judah. But he gave the kingdom to Jehoram, because he was the firstborn.
- 4 *Now when Jehoram was risen up to the kingdom of his father, he strengthened himself, and slew all his brethren with the sword, and divers also of the princes of Israel.* When Jehoram had ascended the throne of his father and had established himself, he killed all his brothers with the sword, and also some of the princes of Israel.
- 5 *Jehoram was thirty and two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.* Jehoram was thirty-two years old when he became king. He reigned eight years in Jerusalem.
- 6 *And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, like as did the house of Ahab: for he had the daughter of Ahab to wife: and he wrought that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD.* He walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as the house of Ahab had done, for the daughter of Ahab was his wife. And he did what was evil in the sight of the LORD.
- 7 *Howbeit the LORD would not destroy the house of David, because of the covenant that he had made with David, and as he promised to give a light to him and to his sons for ever.* Yet the LORD was not willing to destroy the house of David, because of the covenant that he had made with David, and since he had promised to give a lamp to Him and to His sons forever.
- 8 *In his days the Edomites revolted from under the dominion of Judah, and made themselves a king.* In His days Edom revolted from the rule of Judah and set up a king of their own.
- 9 *Then Jehoram went forth with his princes, and all his chariots with him: and he rose up by night, and smote the Edomites which compassed him in, and the captains of the chariots.* Then Jehoram passed over with His commanders and all his chariots. And He rose by night and struck the Edomites who had surrounded Him and his chariot commanders.

- 10 *So the Edomites revolted from under the hand of Judah unto this day. The same time also did Libnah revolt from under his hand; because he had forsaken the LORD God of his fathers.* So Edom revolted from the rule of Judah to this day. At that time Libnah also revolted from His rule, because He had forsaken the LORD, the God of His fathers.
- 11 *Moreover he made high places in the mountains of Judah, and caused the inhabitants of Jerusalem to commit fornication, and compelled Judah thereto.* Moreover, He made high places in the hill country of Judah and led the inhabitants of Jerusalem into whoredom and made Judah go astray.
- 12 *And there came a writing to him from Elijah the prophet, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of David thy father, Because thou hast not walked in the ways of Jehoshaphat thy father, nor in the ways of Asa king of Judah,* A letter came to Him from Elijah the prophet, saying, "Thus says the LORD, the God of David your father, 'Because you have not walked in the ways of Jehoshaphat your father, or in the ways of Asa king of Judah,
- 13 *But hast walked in the way of the kings of Israel, and hast made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem to go a whoring, like to the whoredoms of the house of Ahab, and also hast slain thy brethren of thy father's house, which were better than thyself:* But have walked in the way of the kings of Israel and have made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem go astray, as the house of Ahab led Israel astray, and also you have killed your brothers, of your father's house, who were better than you,
- 14 *Behold, with a great plague will the LORD smite thy people, and thy children, and thy wives, and all thy goods:* The LORD will bring a great plague on Your people, Your children, Your wives. All Your possessions,
- 15 *And thou shalt have great sickness by disease of thy bowels, until thy bowels fall out by reason of the sickness day by day.* You Yourself will have a severe sickness with a disease of Your bowels, until Your bowels come out because of the disease, day by day.' "
- 16 *Moreover the LORD stirred up against Jehoram the spirit of the Philistines, and of the Arabians, that were near the Ethiopians:* The LORD stirred up against Jehoram the anger of the Philistines and of the Arabians who are near the Ethiopians.

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| <p>17 <i>And they came up into Judah, and brake into it, and carried away all the substance that was found in the king's house, and his sons also, and his wives; so that there was never a son left him, save Jehoahaz, the youngest of his sons.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And after all this the LORD smote him in his bowels with an incurable disease.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And it came to pass, that in process of time, after the end of two years, his bowels fell out by reason of his sickness: so he died of sore diseases. And his people made no burning for him, like the burning of his fathers.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Thirty and two years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem eight years, and departed without being desired. Howbeit they buried him in the city of David, but not in the sepulchres of the kings.</i></p> | <p>They came up against Judah and invaded it and carried away all the possessions they found that belonged to the king's house, and also his sons and his wives, so that no son was left to him except Jehoahaz, his youngest son.</p> <p>After all this the LORD struck Him in His bowels with an incurable disease.</p> <p>In the course of time, at the end of two years, His bowels came out because of the disease. He died in great agony. His people made no fire in His honor, like the fires made for His fathers.</p> <p>He was thirty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned eight years in Jerusalem. And he departed with no one's regret. They buried him in the city of David, but not in the tombs of the kings.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Cross-References:

v6 — 2 Chr 18:1

v7 — 1 Kgs 11:36; Ps 132:17-18; 2 Sam 7:12-17; Luke 1:69; Luke 1:79

v12 — 2 Chr 14:2-5; 2 Chr 17:3-4

v13 — 2 Chr 21:4

- v15 — 2 Chr 21:18-19
- v16 — 2 Chr 17:11
- v17 — 2 Chr 22:1
- v18 — 2 Chr 21:15
- v19 — 2 Chr 16:14
- v20 — Jer 22:18

Ahaziah of Judah — 841 BC
Athaliah of Judah — 841–835 BC

Chapter 22

Ahaziah the son of Jehoram reigned one year and walked in the wickedness of the house of Ahab, whose daughter Athaliah was his counselor. Jehu killed Ahaziah, and Athaliah massacred the royal family — but Jehoshabeath hid the infant Joash in the temple.

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| 1 | <i>And the inhabitants of Jerusalem made Ahaziah his youngest son king in his stead: for the band of men that came with the Arabians to the camp had slain all the eldest. So Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah reigned.</i> | The inhabitants of Jerusalem made Ahaziah his youngest son king in his place, for the band of men that came with the Arabians to the camp had killed all the older sons. So Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah reigned. |
| 2 | <i>Forty and two years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Athaliah the daughter of Omri.</i> | Ahaziah was forty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Athaliah, the granddaughter of Omri. |
| 3 | <i>He also walked in the ways of the house of Ahab: for his mother was his counsellor to do wickedly.</i> | He also walked in the ways of the house of Ahab, for his mother was his counselor in doing wickedly. |
| 4 | <i>Wherefore he did evil in the sight of the LORD like the house of Ahab: for they were his counsellors after the death of his father to his destruction.</i> | He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, as the house of Ahab had done. For after the death of his father they were His counselors, to His undoing. |

- 5 *He walked also after their counsel, and went with Jehoram the son of Ahab king of Israel to war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth-gilead: and the Syrians smote Joram.* He even followed their counsel and went with Jehoram the son of Ahab king of Israel to make war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth-gilead. And the Syrians wounded Joram.
- 6 *And he returned to be healed in Jezreel because of the wounds which were given him at Ramah, when he fought with Hazael king of Syria. And Azariah the son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to see Jehoram the son of Ahab at Jezreel, because he was sick.* He returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds that he had received at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. And Azariah the son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to see Joram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.
- 7 *And the destruction of Ahaziah was of God by coming to Joram: for when he was come, he went out with Jehoram against Jehu the son of Nimshi, whom the LORD had anointed to cut off the house of Ahab.* But it was ordained by God that the downfall of Ahaziah should come about through His going to visit Joram. For when He came there, He went out with Jehoram to meet Jehu the son of Nimshi, whom the LORD had anointed to destroy the house of Ahab.
- 8 *And it came to pass, that, when Jehu was executing judgment upon the house of Ahab, and found the princes of Judah, and the sons of the brethren of Ahaziah, that ministered to Ahaziah, he slew them.* When Jehu was executing judgment on the house of Ahab, he met the princes of Judah and the sons of Ahaziah's brothers, who attended Ahaziah. He killed them.
- 9 *And he sought Ahaziah: and they caught him, (for he was hid in Samaria,) and brought him to Jehu: and when they had slain him, they buried him: because, said they, he is the son of Jehoshaphat, who sought the LORD with all his heart. So the house of Ahaziah had no power to keep still the kingdom.* He searched for Ahaziah. He was captured while hiding in Samaria. He was brought to Jehu and put to death. They buried him, for they said, "He is the grandson of Jehoshaphat, who sought the LORD with all His heart." And the house of Ahaziah had no one able to rule the kingdom.

- 10

But when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the seed royal of the house of Judah.
- 11

But Jehoshabeath, the daughter of the king, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him from among the king's sons that were slain, and put him and his nurse in a bedchamber. So Jehoshabeath, the daughter of king Jehoram, the wife of Jehoiada the priest, (for she was the sister of Ahaziah,) hid him from Athaliah; so that she slew him not.
- 12

And he was with them hid in the house of God six years: and Athaliah reigned over the land.
- Now when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the royal family of the house of Judah.
- But Jehoshabeath, the daughter of the king, took Joash the son of Ahaziah and stole him away from among the king's sons who were being put to death. She put him and his nurse in a bedroom. Thus Jehoshabeath, the daughter of King Jehoram and wife of Jehoiada the priest — she was the sister of Ahaziah — hid him from Athaliah, so that she did not put him to death.
- He remained with them six years, hidden in the house of God, while Athaliah reigned over the land.

Words in this chapter:

Ahab (*AY-hab*) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Chr 21:16-17

Chapter 23

In the seventh year the priest Jehoiada organized a coup against Athaliah, bringing out the young king Joash and crowning him. Athaliah was put to death, and Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD, the king, and the people.

- 1 *And in the seventh year Jehoiada strengthened himself, and took the captains of hundreds, Azariah the son of Jeroham, and Ishmael the son of Jehohanan, and Azariah the son of Obed, and Maaseiah the son of Adaiah, and Elishaphat the son of Zichri, into covenant with him.* But in the seventh year Jehoiada strengthened Himself, and made a covenant with the commanders of hundreds, Azariah the son of Jeroham, Ishmael the son of Jehohanan, Azariah the son of Obed, Maaseiah the son of Adaiah, and Elishaphat the son of Zichri.
- 2 *And they went about in Judah, and gathered the Levites out of all the cities of Judah, and the chief of the fathers of Israel, and they came to Jerusalem.* They went through Judah and gathered the Levites from all the cities of Judah, and the heads of fathers' houses of Israel. They came to Jerusalem.
- 3 *And all the congregation made a covenant with the king in the house of God. And he said unto them, Behold, the king's son shall reign, as the LORD hath said of the sons of David.* All the assembly made a covenant with the king in the house of God. And Jehoiada said to them, "The king's son shall reign, as the LORD spoke concerning the sons of David.
- 4 *This is the thing that ye shall do; A third part of you entering on the sabbath, of the priests and of the Levites, shall be porters of the doors;* This is the thing that You shall do: a third of You, those who come off duty on the Sabbath, of the priests and Levites, shall be gatekeepers of the thresholds;
- 5 *And a third part shall be at the king's house; and a third part at the gate of the foundation: and all the people shall be in the courts of the house of the LORD.* A third shall be at the king's house. A third at the Gate of the Foundation. And all the people shall be in the courts of the house of the LORD.
- 6 *But let none come into the house of the LORD, save the priests, and they that minister of the Levites; they shall go in, for they are holy: but all the people shall keep the watch of the LORD.* Let no one enter the house of the LORD except the priests and the Levites who minister there. They may enter, for they are holy. But all the other people shall keep the watch of the LORD.

- 7 *And the Levites shall compass the king round about, every man with his weapons in his hand; and whosoever else cometh into the house, he shall be put to death: but be ye with the king when he cometh in, and when he goeth out.*
- The Levites shall surround the king, each with his weapons in his hand. And whoever enters the house shall be put to death. Be with the king when he comes in and when he goes out."
- 8 *So the Levites and all Judah did according to all things that Jehoiada the priest had commanded, and took every man his men that were to come in on the sabbath, with them that were to go out on the sabbath: for Jehoiada the priest dismissed not the courses.*
- The Levites and all Judah did according to all that Jehoiada the priest commanded. Each brought his men who were to come on duty on the Sabbath, along with those who were to go off duty on the Sabbath, for Jehoiada the priest did not dismiss the divisions.
- 9 *Moreover Jehoiada the priest delivered to the captains of hundreds spears, and bucklers, and shields, that had been king David's, which were in the house of God.*
- Jehoiada the priest gave to the commanders of hundreds the spears and the large and small shields that had been King David's and that were in the house of God.
- 10 *And he set all the people, every man having his weapon in his hand, from the right side of the temple to the left side of the temple, along by the altar and the temple, by the king round about.*
- He set all the people as a guard for the king, every man with his weapon in his hand, from the south side of the house to the north side of the house, around the altar and the house.
- 11 *Then they brought out the king's son, and put upon him the crown, and gave him the testimony, and made him king. And Jehoiada and his sons anointed him, and said, God save the king.*
- Then they brought out the king's son and put the crown on him and gave him the testimony. And they proclaimed him king, and Jehoiada and his sons anointed him. They said, "Long live the king!"

- 12 *Now when Athaliah heard the noise of the people running and praising the king, she came to the people into the house of the LORD:* When Athaliah heard the noise of the people running and praising the king, she went into the house of the LORD to the people.
- 13 *And she looked, and, behold, the king stood at his pillar at the entering in, and the princes and the trumpets by the king: and all the people of the land rejoiced, and sounded with trumpets, also the singers with instruments of musick, and such as taught to sing praise. Then Athaliah rent her clothes, and said, Treason, Treason.* She looked, and there was the king standing by his pillar at the entrance, and the commanders and the trumpeters beside the king, and all the people of the land rejoicing and sounding trumpets, with the singers and instruments of music leading in the praise. Then Athaliah tore her clothes and cried, "Treason! Treason!"
- 14 *Then Jehoiada the priest brought out the captains of hundreds that were set over the host, and said unto them, Have her forth of the ranges: and whoso followeth her, let him be slain with the sword. For the priest said, Slay her not in the house of the LORD.* Then Jehoiada the priest brought out the commanders of hundreds who were set over the army, and said to them, "Bring her out between the ranks, and anyone who follows her is to be put to death with the sword." For the priest said, "Do not put her to death in the house of the LORD."
- 15 *So they laid hands on her; and when she was come to the entering of the horse gate by the king's house, they slew her there.* So they laid hands on her. She went into the entrance of the horse gate of the king's house. They put her to death there.
- 16 *And Jehoiada made a covenant between him, and between all the people, and between the king, that they should be the LORD's people.* Then Jehoiada made a covenant between Himself and all the people and the king that they should be the LORD's people.
- 17 *Then all the people went to the house of Baal, and brake it down, and brake his altars and his images in pieces, and slew Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.* Then all the people went to the house of Baal and tore it down; his altars and his images they broke in pieces. They killed Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.

- 18

Also Jehoiada appointed the offices of the house of the LORD by the hand of the priests the Levites, whom David had distributed in the house of the LORD, to offer the burnt offerings of the LORD, as it is written in the law of Moses, with rejoicing and with singing, as it was ordained by David.
- Jehoiada posted watchmen for the house of the LORD under the direction of the Levitical priests and the Levites whom David had organized to be in charge of the house of the LORD, to offer burnt offerings to the LORD, as it is written in the Law of Moses, with rejoicing and with singing, according to the order of David.
- 19

And he set the porters at the gates of the house of the LORD, that none which was unclean in any thing should enter in.
- He stationed the gatekeepers at the gates of the house of the LORD so that no one who was in any way unclean should enter.
- 20

And he took the captains of hundreds, and the nobles, and the governors of the people, and all the people of the land, and brought down the king from the house of the LORD: and they came through the upper gate into the king's house, and set the king upon the throne of the kingdom.
- He took the commanders of hundreds, the nobles, the governors of the people, and all the people of the land, and brought the king down from the house of the LORD, marching through the upper gate to the king's house. And they set the king on the royal throne.
- 21

And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet, after that they had slain Athaliah with the sword.
- All the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet after Athaliah had been put to death with the sword.

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

v11 — 1 Sam 10:24

v15 — Neh 3:28

v21 — 2 Kgs 11:20

Joash of Judah — 835–796 BC

Chapter 24

Joash reigned well while Jehoiada the priest lived, repairing the temple with a collection chest at the gate. After Jehoiada died, Joash turned to idolatry, murdered Zechariah the priest who rebuked him, and was assassinated by his own servants.

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| 1 | <i>Joash was seven years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Zibiah of Beersheba.</i> | Joash was seven years old when he began to reign. He reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zibiah of Beersheba. |
| 2 | <i>And Joash did that which was right in the sight of the LORD all the days of Jehoiada the priest.</i> | Joash did what was right in the eyes of the LORD all the days of Jehoiada the priest. |
| 3 | <i>And Jehoiada took for him two wives; and he begat sons and daughters.</i> | Jehoiada got two wives for Him. He had sons and daughters. |
| 4 | <i>And it came to pass after this, that Joash was minded to repair the house of the LORD.</i> | After this Joash decided to restore the house of the LORD. |
| 5 | <i>And he gathered together the priests and the Levites, and said to them, Go out unto the cities of Judah, and gather of all Israel money to repair the house of your God from year to year, and see that ye hasten the matter. Howbeit the Levites hastened it not.</i> | He assembled the priests and the Levites and said to them, "Go out to the cities of Judah and gather from all Israel money to repair the house of Your God from year to year, and see that You act quickly." But the Levites did not act quickly. |
| 6 | <i>And the king called for Jehoiada the chief, and said unto him, Why hast thou not required of the Levites to bring in out of Judah and out of Jerusalem the collection, according to the commandment of Moses the servant of the LORD, and of the congregation of Israel, for the tabernacle of witness?</i> | So the king summoned Jehoiada the chief and said to him, "Why have You not required the Levites to bring in from Judah and Jerusalem the tax levied by Moses, the servant of the LORD, and the congregation of Israel for the tent of testimony?" |

- 7 *For the sons of Athaliah, that wicked woman, had broken up the house of God; and also all the dedicated things of the house of the LORD did they bestow upon Baalim.* For the sons of Athaliah, that wicked woman, had broken into the house of God, and had also used all the dedicated things of the house of the LORD for the Baals.
- 8 *And at the king's commandment they made a chest, and set it without at the gate of the house of the LORD.* So the king commanded. They made a chest and set it outside the gate of the house of the LORD.
- 9 *And they made a proclamation through Judah and Jerusalem, to bring in to the LORD the collection that Moses the servant of God laid upon Israel in the wilderness.* Proclamation was made throughout Judah and Jerusalem to bring in for the LORD the tax that Moses the servant of God laid on Israel in the wilderness.
- 10 *And all the princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest, until they had made an end.* All the princes and all the people rejoiced and brought their tax and dropped it into the chest until they had finished.
- 11 *Now it came to pass, that at what time the chest was brought unto the king's office by the hand of the Levites, and when they saw that there was much money, the king's secretary and the high priest's officer came and emptied the chest, and took it, and carried it to his place again. Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in abundance.* Whenever the chest was brought to the king's officers by the Levites, when they saw that there was much money in it, the king's secretary and the chief priest's officer would come and empty the chest and take it and return it to its place. Thus they did day after day, and collected money in abundance.
- 12 *And the king and Jehoiada gave it to such as did the work of the service of the house of the LORD, and hired masons and carpenters to repair the house of the LORD, and also such as wrought iron and brass to mend the house of the LORD.* The king and Jehoiada gave it to those who did the work of the service of the house of the LORD. They hired masons and carpenters to restore the house of the LORD, and also workers in iron and bronze to repair the house of the LORD.

- 13 *So the workmen wrought, and the work was perfected by them, and they set the house of God in his state, and strengthened it.* So those who were engaged in the work labored, and the repairing went forward in their hands. They restored the house of God to its proper condition and strengthened it.
- 14 *And when they had finished it, they brought the rest of the money before the king and Jehoiada, whereof were made vessels for the house of the LORD, even vessels to minister, and to offer withal, and spoons, and vessels of gold and silver. And they offered burnt offerings in the house of the LORD continually all the days of Jehoiada.* When they had finished, they brought the rest of the money before the king and Jehoiada, and with it were made utensils for the house of the LORD, both for the service and for the burnt offerings, and dishes for incense and vessels of gold and silver. And they offered burnt offerings in the house of the LORD regularly all the days of Jehoiada.
- 15 *But Jehoiada waxed old, and was full of days when he died; an hundred and thirty years old was he when he died.* But Jehoiada grew old and full of days, and died. He was one hundred thirty years old at His death.
- 16 *And they buried him in the city of David among the kings, because he had done good in Israel, both toward God, and toward his house.* They buried him in the city of David among the kings, because he had done good in Israel, and toward God and His house.
- 17 *Now after the death of Jehoiada came the princes of Judah, and made obeisance to the king. Then the king hearkened unto them.* Now after the death of Jehoiada the princes of Judah came and paid homage to the king. Then the king listened to them.
- 18 *And they left the house of the LORD God of their fathers, and served groves and idols: and wrath came upon Judah and Jerusalem for this their trespass.* They abandoned the house of the LORD, the God of their fathers, and served the groves and the idols. And wrath came upon Judah and Jerusalem for this their trespass.
- 19 *Yet he sent prophets to them, to bring them again unto the LORD; and they testified against them: but they would not give ear.* Yet He sent prophets among them to bring them back to the LORD. These testified against them. But they would not pay attention.

- 20 *And the Spirit of God came upon Zechariah the son of Jehoiada the priest, which stood above the people, and said unto them, Thus saith God, Why transgress ye the commandments of the LORD, that ye cannot prosper? because ye have forsaken the LORD, he hath also forsaken you.* Then the Spirit of God clothed Zechariah the son of Jehoiada the priest. He stood above the people, and said to them, "Thus says God, 'Why do You break the commandments of the LORD, so that You cannot prosper? Because You have forsaken the LORD, He has forsaken You.' "
- 21 *And they conspired against him, and stoned him with stones at the commandment of the king in the court of the house of the LORD.* But they conspired against Him, and by command of the king they stoned him with stones in the court of the house of the LORD.
- 22 *Thus Joash the king remembered not the kindness which Jehoiada his father had done to him, but slew his son. And when he died, he said, The LORD look upon it, and require it.* Thus Joash the king did not remember the kindness that Jehoiada, Zechariah's father, had shown him, but killed his son. And when He was dying, He said, "May the LORD see and avenge!"
- 23 *And it came to pass at the end of the year, that the host of Syria came up against him: and they came to Judah and Jerusalem, and destroyed all the princes of the people from among the people, and sent all the spoil of them unto the king of Damascus.* At the end of the year the army of the Syrians came up against Joash. They came to Judah and Jerusalem and destroyed all the princes of the people from among the people and sent all their spoil to the king of Damascus.
- 24 *For the army of the Syrians came with a small company of men, and the LORD delivered a very great host into their hand, because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers. So they executed judgment against Joash.* Though the army of the Syrians had come with few men, the LORD delivered into their hand a very great army, because Judah had forsaken the LORD, the God of their fathers. Thus they executed judgment on Joash.

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And when they were departed from him, (for they left him in great diseases,) his own servants conspired against him for the blood of the sons of Jehoiada the priest, and slew him on his bed, and he died: and they buried him in the city of David, but they buried him not in the sepulchres of the kings.
- When they had departed from him, leaving him severely wounded, his servants conspired against him because of the blood of the son of Jehoiada the priest, and killed him on his bed. So he died. They buried him in the city of David. But they did not bury him in the tombs of the kings.
- 26

And these are they that conspired against him; Zabad the son of Shimeath an Ammonitess, and Jehozabad the son of Shimrith a Moabite.
- Those who conspired against him were Zabad the son of Shimeath the Ammonite, and Jehozabad the son of Shimrith the Moabite.
- 27

Now concerning his sons, and the greatness of the burdens laid upon him, and the repairing of the house of God, behold, they are written in the story of the book of the kings. And Amaziah his son reigned in his stead.
- Accounts of his sons and of the many oracles against him and of the rebuilding of the house of God are written in the commentary on the Book of the Kings. And Amaziah his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

- burnt offering** — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.
- tabernacle** — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Ex 30:12-16
- v16 — Heb 6:10
- v18 — Josh 22:20
- v20 — Num 14:41; Jer 5:25
- v22 — Gen 9:5; Luke 11:51

Amaziah of Judah — 796–767 BC

Chapter 25

Amaziah defeated the Edomites in the Valley of Salt but then brought back their gods and worshipped them. He challenged Joash king of Israel, was defeated, and Jerusalem's wall was broken down; he was later killed by conspirators.

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| 1 | <i>Amaziah was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.</i> | Amaziah was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, but not with a perfect heart.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, yet not with a whole heart. |
| 3 | <i>Now it came to pass, when the kingdom was established to him, that he slew his servants that had killed the king his father.</i> | As soon as the royal power was firmly his, he killed his servants who had struck down the king his father. |
| 4 | <i>But he slew not their children, but did as it is written in the law in the book of Moses, where the LORD commanded, saying, The fathers shall not die for the children, neither shall the children die for the fathers, but every man shall die for his own sin.</i> | But He did not put their children to death, according to what is written in the Law, in the Book of Moses, where the LORD commanded, "Fathers shall not die because of their children, nor children die because of their fathers, but each one shall die for his own sin." |
| 5 | <i>Moreover Amaziah gathered Judah together, and made them captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, according to the houses of their fathers, throughout all Judah and Benjamin: and he numbered them from twenty years old and above, and found them three hundred thousand choice men, able to go forth to war, that could handle spear and shield.</i> | Then Amaziah assembled Judah and set them by fathers' houses under commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds for all Judah and Benjamin. He mustered those twenty years old and upward, and found that they were three hundred thousand choice men, fit for war, able to handle spear and shield. |
| 6 | <i>He hired also an hundred thousand mighty men of valour out of Israel for an hundred talents of silver.</i> | He hired also one hundred thousand mighty warriors from Israel for one hundred talents of silver. |

- 7 *But there came a man of God to him, saying, O king, let not the army of Israel go with thee; for the LORD is not with Israel, to wit, with all the children of Ephraim.* But a man of God came to Him and said, "O king, do not let the army of Israel go with You, for the LORD is not with Israel, with all these Ephraimites.
- 8 *But if thou wilt go, do it, be strong for the battle: God shall make thee fall before the enemy: for God hath power to help, and to cast down.* But if You go, be strong for the battle. Yet God shall make You fall before the enemy, for God has power to help and to cast down."
- 9 *And Amaziah said to the man of God, But what shall we do for the hundred talents which I have given to the army of Israel? And the man of God answered, The LORD is able to give thee much more than this.* Amaziah said to the man of God, "But what shall we do about the hundred talents that I have given to the army of Israel?" The man of God answered, "The LORD is able to give You much more than this."
- 10 *Then Amaziah separated them, to wit, the army that was come to him out of Ephraim, to go home again: wherefore their anger was greatly kindled against Judah, and they returned home in great anger.* Then Amaziah set apart the army that had come to him from Ephraim and sent them home again. And they became very angry with Judah and returned home in fierce anger.
- 11 *And Amaziah strengthened himself, and led forth his people, and went to the valley of salt, and smote of the children of Seir ten thousand.* But Amaziah took courage and led his people out and went to the Valley of Salt and struck down ten thousand men of Seir.
- 12 *And other ten thousand left alive did the children of Judah carry away captive, and brought them unto the top of the rock, and cast them down from the top of the rock, that they all were broken in pieces.* The people of Judah captured another ten thousand alive and took them to the top of a rock and threw them down from the top of the rock. They were all dashed to pieces.

- 13 *But the soldiers of the army which Amaziah sent back, that they should not go with him to battle, fell upon the cities of Judah, from Samaria even unto Bethhoron, and smote three thousand of them, and took much spoil.* But the men of the army whom Amaziah sent back, not letting them go with him to battle, raided the cities of Judah, from Samaria to Beth-horon, and struck down three thousand people in them and took much plunder.
- 14 *Now it came to pass, after that Amaziah was come from the slaughter of the Edomites, that he brought the gods of the children of Seir, and set them up to be his gods, and bowed down himself before them, and burned incense unto them.* After Amaziah came from striking down the Edomites, he brought the gods of the men of Seir and set them up as His gods and worshiped them, making offerings to them.
- 15 *Wherefore the anger of the LORD was kindled against Amaziah, and he sent unto him a prophet, which said unto him, Why hast thou sought after the gods of the people, which could not deliver their own people out of thine hand?* Therefore the LORD was angry with Amaziah and sent to him a prophet, who said to him, "Why have You sought the gods of a people who did not deliver their own people from Your hand?"
- 16 *And it came to pass, as he talked with him, that the king said unto him, Art thou made of the king's counsel? forbear; why shouldest thou be smitten? Then the prophet forbore, and said, I know that God hath determined to destroy thee, because thou hast done this, and hast not hearkened unto my counsel.* But as he was speaking, the king said to him, "Have we made you a royal counselor? Stop! Why should you be struck down?" So the prophet stopped, but said, "I know that God has determined to destroy you, because you have done this and have not listened to my counsel."
- 17 *Then Amaziah king of Judah took advice, and sent to Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, the son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, Come, let us see one another in the face.* Then Amaziah king of Judah took counsel and sent to Joash the son of Jehoahaz, son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, "Come, let us face one another in battle."

- 18 *And Joash king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, Give thy daughter to my son to wife: and there passed by a wild beast that was in Lebanon, and trode down the thistle.*
- 19 *Thou sayest, Lo, thou hast smitten the Edomites; and thine heart lifteth thee up to boast: abide now at home; why shouldest thou meddle to thine hurt, that thou shouldest fall, even thou, and Judah with thee?*
- 20 *But Amaziah would not hear; for it came of God, that he might deliver them into the hand of their enemies, because they sought after the gods of Edom.*
- 21 *So Joash the king of Israel went up; and they saw one another in the face, both he and Amaziah king of Judah, at Bethshemesh, which belongeth to Judah.*
- 22 *And Judah was put to the worse before Israel, and they fled every man to his tent.*
- 23 *And Joash the king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, at Bethshemesh, and brought him to Jerusalem, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate, four hundred cubits.*
- Joash king of Israel sent word to Amaziah king of Judah, "A thistle on Lebanon sent to a cedar on Lebanon, saying, 'Give your daughter to my son for a wife,' and a wild animal of Lebanon passed by and trampled down the thistle.
- You say, 'See, I have struck down Edom,' and your heart has lifted you up in boastfulness. But now stay at home. Why should you provoke trouble so that you fall, you and Judah with you?"
- But Amaziah would not listen, for it was of God, in order that He might give them into the hand of their enemies, because they had sought the gods of Edom.
- So Joash king of Israel went up. He and Amaziah king of Judah faced one another in battle at Beth-shemesh, which belongs to Judah.
- Judah was defeated by Israel, and every man fled to his home.
- Joash king of Israel captured Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash, son of Jehoahaz, at Beth-shemesh and brought him to Jerusalem and broke down the wall of Jerusalem for four hundred cubits, from the Ephraim Gate to the Corner Gate.

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| <p>24 <i>And he took all the gold and the silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of God with Obededom, and the treasures of the king's house, the hostages also, and returned to Samaria.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah lived after the death of Joash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel fifteen years.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, first and last, behold, are they not written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel?</i></p> <p>27 <i>Now after the time that Amaziah did turn away from following the LORD they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem; and he fled to Lachish: but they sent to Lachish after him, and slew him there.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And they brought him upon horses, and buried him with his fathers in the city of Judah.</i></p> | <p>He seized all the gold and silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of God with Obed-edom, and the treasures of the king's house, and the hostages, and returned to Samaria.</p> <p>Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, lived fifteen years after the death of Joash the son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel.</p> <p>Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, from first to last, are they not written in the Book of the Kings of Judah and Israel?</p> <p>From the time when Amaziah turned away from the LORD they made a conspiracy against Him in Jerusalem. He fled to Lachish. But they sent after Him to Lachish and put Him to death there.</p> <p>They brought Him upon horses and buried Him with His fathers in the city of Judah.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Edomites (*EE-dom-ytes*) — The descendants of Esau — settled south of the Dead Sea in the region of Edom (Seir); long-standing enemies of Israel despite their kinship.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v2 — 2 Chr 25:14; Jas 4:8; Acts 8:21; Isa 29:13; 2 Chr 24:2

v4 — Deut 24:16; Ezek 18:20; Jer 31:29-30; 2 Kgs 14:5-6; Ezek 18:4

v5 — Num 1:3

v8 — 2 Chr 14:11; 2 Chr 20:6

v9 — Prov 10:22; Deut 8:18

v14 — 2 Chr 28:23

Uzziah (Azariah) of Judah — 767–740 BC

Chapter 26

Uzziah reigned fifty-two years and prospered as long as he sought the LORD, building towers and maintaining a great army. But he grew proud and entered the temple to burn incense; God struck him with leprosy, and he lived in isolation until his death.

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| 1 | <i>Then all the people of Judah took Uzziah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king in the room of his father Amaziah.</i> | All the people of Judah took Uzziah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king instead of his father Amaziah. |
| 2 | <i>He built Eloth, and restored it to Judah, after that the king slept with his fathers.</i> | He built Eloth and restored it to Judah, after the king slept with his fathers. |
| 3 | <i>Sixteen years old was Uzziah when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty and two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Jecoliah of Jerusalem.</i> | Uzziah was sixteen years old when he began to reign. He reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jecoliah of Jerusalem. |
| 4 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Amaziah did.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that His father Amaziah had done. |
| 5 | <i>And he sought God in the days of Zechariah, who had understanding in the visions of God: and as long as he sought the LORD, God made him to prosper.</i> | He set Himself to seek God in the days of Zechariah, who instructed him in the fear of God, and as long as He sought the LORD, God made Him prosper. |
| 6 | <i>And he went forth and warred against the Philistines, and brake down the wall of Gath, and the wall of Jabneh, and the wall of Ashdod, and built cities about Ashdod, and among the Philistines.</i> | He went out and made war against the Philistines and broke down the wall of Gath and the wall of Jabneh and the wall of Ashdod. He built cities in the territory of Ashdod and elsewhere among the Philistines. |

- 7 *And God helped him against the Philistines, and against the Arabians that dwelt in Gurbaal, and the Mehunims.* God helped Him against the Philistines and against the Arabians who lived in Gur-baal and against the Meunites.
- 8 *And the Ammonites gave gifts to Uzziah: and his name spread abroad even to the entering in of Egypt; for he strengthened himself exceedingly.* The Ammonites paid tribute to Uzziah. His fame spread even to the border of Egypt, for he became very strong.
- 9 *Moreover Uzziah built towers in Jerusalem at the corner gate, and at the valley gate, and at the turning of the wall, and fortified them.* Moreover, Uzziah built towers in Jerusalem at the Corner Gate and at the Valley Gate and at the Angle. He fortified them.
- 10 *Also he built towers in the desert, and digged many wells: for he had much cattle, both in the low country, and in the plains: husbandmen also, and vine dressers in the mountains, and in Carmel: for he loved husbandry.* He built towers in the wilderness and cut out many cisterns, for he had large herds, both in the Shephelah and in the plain. He had farmers and vinedressers in the hills and in the fertile lands, for he loved the soil.
- 11 *Moreover Uzziah had an host of fighting men, that went out to war by bands, according to the number of their account by the hand of Jeiel the scribe and Maaseiah the ruler, under the hand of Hananiah, one of the king's captains.* Moreover, Uzziah had an army of soldiers, fit for war, who went to battle in divisions, according to the numbers in the muster made by Jeiel the secretary and Maaseiah the officer, under the direction of Hananiah, one of the king's commanders.
- 12 *The whole number of the chief of the fathers of the mighty men of valour were two thousand and six hundred.* The whole number of the heads of fathers' houses of mighty warriors was two thousand six hundred.
- 13 *And under their hand was an army, three hundred thousand and seven thousand and five hundred, that made war with mighty power, to help the king against the enemy.* Under their command was an army of three hundred seven thousand five hundred who could make war with mighty power, to help the king against the enemy.

- 14 *And Uzziah prepared for them throughout all the host shields, and spears, and helmets, and habergeons, and bows, and slings to cast stones.* Uzziah prepared for all the army shields, spears, helmets, coats of mail, bows, and stones for slinging.
- 15 *And he made in Jerusalem engines, invented by cunning men, to be on the towers and upon the bulwarks, to shoot arrows and great stones withal. And his name spread far abroad; for he was marvellously helped, till he was strong.* In Jerusalem he made machines, invented by skillful men, to be on the towers and the corners, to shoot arrows and large stones. And his fame spread far, for he was marvelously helped, until he was strong.
- 16 *But when he was strong, his heart was lifted up to his destruction: for he transgressed against the LORD his God, and went into the temple of the LORD to burn incense upon the altar of incense.* But when He was strong, He grew proud, to His destruction. For He was unfaithful to the LORD His God and entered the temple of the LORD to burn incense on the altar of incense.
- 17 *And Azariah the priest went in after him, and with him fourscore priests of the LORD, that were valiant men:* But Azariah the priest went in after him, with eighty priests of the LORD Who were men of valor,
- 18 *And they withstood Uzziah the king, and said unto him, It appertaineth not unto thee, Uzziah, to burn incense unto the LORD, but to the priests the sons of Aaron, that are consecrated to burn incense: go out of the sanctuary; for thou hast trespassed; neither shall it be for thine honour from the LORD God.* They withstood King Uzziah and said to him, "It is not for you, Uzziah, to burn incense to the LORD, but for the priests, the sons of Aaron, who are consecrated to burn incense. Go out of the sanctuary, for You have done wrong. It will bring You no honor from the LORD God."

- 19 *Then Uzziah was wroth, and had a censer in his hand to burn incense: and while he was wroth with the priests, the leprosy even rose up in his forehead before the priests in the house of the LORD, beside the altar of incense.* Then Uzziah was angry. Now he had a censer in his hand to burn incense, and when He became angry with the priests, leprosy broke out on His forehead in the presence of the priests in the house of the LORD, beside the altar of incense.
- 20 *And Azariah the chief priest, and all the priests, looked upon him, and, behold, he was leprous in his forehead, and they thrust him out from thence; yea, himself hasted also to go out, because the LORD had smitten him.* Azariah the chief priest and all the priests looked at Him. He was leprous in His forehead! And they rushed Him out quickly. He Himself hurried to go out, because the LORD had struck Him.
- 21 *And Uzziah the king was a leper unto the day of his death, and dwelt in a several house, being a leper; for he was cut off from the house of the LORD: and Jotham his son was over the king's house, judging the people of the land.* King Uzziah was a leper to the day of his death, and being a leper lived in a separate house, for He was excluded from the house of the LORD. And Jotham his son was over the king's household, governing the people of the land.
- 22 *Now the rest of the acts of Uzziah, first and last, did Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, write.* Now the rest of the acts of Uzziah, from first to last, Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz wrote.
- 23 *So Uzziah slept with his fathers, and they buried him with his fathers in the field of the burial which belonged to the kings; for they said, He is a leper: and Jotham his son reigned in his stead.* Uzziah slept with his fathers. They buried him with his fathers in the burial field that belonged to the kings, for they said, "He is a leper." And Jotham his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v5 — 2 Chr 15:2; 2 Chr 24:2; 1 Chr 22:13; Dan 5:16; Gen 41:38
- v6 — Isa 14:29
- v7 — 2 Chr 21:16
- v9 — Neh 3:13
- v16 — 2 Chr 32:25; 2 Chr 25:19; Prov 16:18; Hab 2:4; Deut 8:14
- v17 — 1 Chr 6:10
- v18 — Ex 30:7-8; Num 18:7
- v21 — Lev 13:46
- v22 — Isa 1:1

Jotham of Judah — 740–732 BC

Chapter 27

Jotham did what was right in the eyes of the LORD and became mighty because he ordered his ways before God. He built the upper gate of the temple, fortified cities, and defeated the Ammonites.

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| 1 | <i>Jotham was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Jerushah, the daughter of Zadok.</i> | Jotham was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jerushah the daughter of Zadok. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Uzziah did: howbeit he entered not into the temple of the LORD. And the people did yet corruptly.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD according to all that His father Uzziah had done — except he did not enter the temple of the LORD. But the people still acted corruptly. |
| 3 | <i>He built the high gate of the house of the LORD, and on the wall of Ophel he built much.</i> | He built the upper gate of the house of the LORD and did extensive building on the wall of Ophel. |
| 4 | <i>Moreover he built cities in the mountains of Judah, and in the forests he built castles and towers.</i> | He built cities in the hill country of Judah, and forts and towers on the wooded hills. |

- 5

He fought also with the king of the Ammonites, and prevailed against them. And the children of Ammon gave him the same year an hundred talents of silver, and ten thousand measures of wheat, and ten thousand of barley. So much did the children of Ammon pay him, both the second year, and the third.
- 6

So Jotham became mighty, because he prepared his ways before the LORD his God.
- 7

Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all his wars, and his ways, lo, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.
- 8

He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem.
- 9

And Jotham slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David: and Ahaz his son reigned in his stead.
- He fought with the king of the Ammonites and prevailed against them. And the Ammonites gave him that year one hundred talents of silver, and ten thousand cors of wheat and ten thousand of barley. The Ammonites paid him the same amount in the second and the third years.
- So Jotham became mighty, because he ordered his ways before the LORD His God.
- Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all his wars and his ways, they are written in the Book of the Kings of Israel and Judah.
- He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem.
- Jotham slept with his fathers. They buried him in the city of David, and Ahaz his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Cross-References:

v3 — 2 Chr 33:14
v6 — 2 Chr 26:5

Ahaz of Judah — 732–715 BC

Chapter 28

Ahaz did not walk in the ways of the LORD but made images for the Baals and burned his sons in the fire. God delivered him into the hands of Syria and Israel, who killed and captured vast numbers; Ahaz then sought help from Assyria, which only oppressed him further.

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| 1 | <i>Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem: but he did not that which was right in the sight of the LORD, like David his father:</i> | Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign. He reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. And He did not do what was right in the eyes of the LORD, as His father David had done, |
| 2 | <i>For he walked in the ways of the kings of Israel, and made also molten images for Baalim.</i> | But He walked in the ways of the kings of Israel. He even made metal images for the Baals, |
| 3 | <i>Moreover he burnt incense in the valley of the son of Hinnom, and burnt his children in the fire, after the abominations of the heathen whom the LORD had cast out before the children of Israel.</i> | He made offerings in the Valley of the Son of Hinnom and burned His sons as an offering, according to the abominations of the nations whom the LORD drove out before the people of Israel. |
| 4 | <i>He sacrificed also and burnt incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree.</i> | He sacrificed and made offerings on the high places and on the hills and under every green tree. |
| 5 | <i>Wherefore the LORD his God delivered him into the hand of the king of Syria; and they smote him, and carried away a great multitude of them captives, and brought them to Damascus. And he was also delivered into the hand of the king of Israel, who smote him with a great slaughter.</i> | Therefore the LORD His God gave Him into the hand of the king of Syria, who defeated him and took captive a great number of His people and brought them to Damascus. He was also given into the hand of the king of Israel, who struck him with great force. |
| 6 | <i>For Pekah the son of Remaliah slew in Judah an hundred and twenty thousand in one day, which were all valiant men; because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers.</i> | For Pekah the son of Remaliah killed one hundred twenty thousand from Judah in one day, all of them men of valor, because they had forsaken the LORD, the God of their fathers. |

- 7 *And Zichri, a mighty man of Ephraim, slew Maaseiah the king's son, and Azrikam the governor of the house, and Elkanah that was next to the king.* Zichri, a mighty man of Ephraim, killed Maaseiah the king's son and Azrikam the commander of the palace and Elkanah the next in authority to the king.
- 8 *And the children of Israel carried away captive of their brethren two hundred thousand, women, sons, and daughters, and took also away much spoil from them, and brought the spoil to Samaria.* The people of Israel took captive two hundred thousand of their relatives, women, sons, and daughters. They also took much spoil from them and brought the spoil to Samaria.
- 9 *But a prophet of the LORD was there, whose name was Oded: and he went out before the host that came to Samaria, and said unto them, Behold, because the LORD God of your fathers was wroth with Judah, he hath delivered them into your hand, and ye have slain them in a rage that reacheth up unto heaven.* But a prophet of the LORD was there, whose name was Oded. He went out to meet the army that came to Samaria and said to them, "Because the LORD, the God of Your fathers, was angry with Judah, He gave them into Your hand, but You have killed them in a rage that has reached up to heaven.
- 10 *And now ye purpose to keep under the children of Judah and Jerusalem for bondmen and bondwomen unto you: but are there not with you, even with you, sins against the LORD your God?* Now You intend to subjugate the people of Judah and Jerusalem, male and female, as Your slaves. Have You not sins of Your own against the LORD Your God?
- 11 *Now hear me therefore, and deliver the captives again, which ye have taken captive of your brethren: for the fierce wrath of the LORD is upon you.* Now hear me, and send back the captives from Your brothers whom You have taken, for the fierce wrath of the LORD is upon You."

- 12 *Then certain of the heads of the children of Ephraim, Azariah the son of Johanan, Berechiah the son of Meshillemoth, and Jehizkiah the son of Shallum, and Amasa the son of Hadlai, stood up against them that came from the war,* Certain chiefs also of the men of Ephraim, Azariah the son of Johanan, Berechiah the son of Meshillemoth, Jehizkiah the son of Shallum, and Amasa the son of Hadlai, stood up against those who were coming from the war
- 13 *And said unto them, Ye shall not bring in the captives hither: for whereas we have offended against the LORD already, ye intend to add more to our sins and to our trespass: for our trespass is great, and there is fierce wrath against Israel.* Said to them, "You shall not bring the captives in here, for You propose to bring upon us guilt against the LORD in addition to our present sins and guilt. For our guilt is already great, and there is fierce wrath against Israel."
- 14 *So the armed men left the captives and the spoil before the princes and all the congregation.* So the armed men left the captives and the spoil before the princes and all the assembly.
- 15 *And the men which were expressed by name rose up, and took the captives, and with the spoil clothed all that were naked among them, and arrayed them, and shod them, and gave them to eat and to drink, and anointed them, and carried all the feeble of them upon asses, and brought them to Jericho, the city of palm trees, to their brethren: then they returned to Samaria.* The men who have been mentioned by name rose and took the captives, and with the spoil they clothed all who were naked among them. They clothed them, gave them sandals, provided them with food and drink, and anointed them, and carrying all the feeble among them on donkeys, they brought them to their brothers at Jericho, the city of palm trees. Then they returned to Samaria.
- 16 *At that time did king Ahaz send unto the kings of Assyria to help him.* At that time King Ahaz sent to the king of Assyria for help.
- 17 *For again the Edomites had come and smitten Judah, and carried away captives.* For the Edomites had again invaded and defeated Judah and carried away captives.

- 18 *The Philistines also had invaded the cities of the low country, and of the south of Judah, and had taken Bethshemesh, and Ajalon, and Gederoth, and Shocho with the villages thereof, and Timnah with the villages thereof, Gimzo also and the villages thereof; and they dwelt there.* The Philistines had invaded the cities of the low country and of the south of Judah and had taken Bethshemesh, Ajalon, Gederoth, Shocho with its villages, Timnah with its villages, and Gimzo with its villages. And they dwelt there.
- 19 *For the LORD brought Judah low because of Ahaz king of Israel; for he made Judah naked, and transgressed sore against the LORD.* For the LORD humbled Judah because of Ahaz king of Israel, for he had made Judah act sinfully and had been very unfaithful to the LORD.
- 20 *And Tilgathpilneser king of Assyria came unto him, and distressed him, but strengthened him not.* So Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria came against Him and afflicted Him instead of strengthening Him.
- 21 *For Ahaz took away a portion out of the house of the LORD, and out of the house of the king, and of the princes, and gave it unto the king of Assyria: but he helped him not.* For Ahaz took a portion from the house of the LORD and the house of the king and of the princes, and gave tribute to the king of Assyria. But it did not help him.
- 22 *And in the time of his distress did he trespass yet more against the LORD: this is that king Ahaz.* In the time of His distress He became yet more faithless to the LORD — this same King Ahaz.
- 23 *For he sacrificed unto the gods of Damascus, which smote him: and he said, Because the gods of the kings of Syria help them, therefore will I sacrifice to them, that they may help me. But they were the ruin of him, and of all Israel.* For He sacrificed to the gods of Damascus that had defeated Him and said, "Because the gods of the kings of Syria helped them, I will sacrifice to them that they may help me." But they were the ruin of Him and of all Israel.

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| <p>24 <i>And Ahaz gathered together the vessels of the house of God, and cut in pieces the vessels of the house of God, and shut up the doors of the house of the LORD, and he made him altars in every corner of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And in every several city of Judah he made high places to burn incense unto other gods, and provoked to anger the LORD God of his fathers.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Now the rest of his acts and of all his ways, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And Ahaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city, even in Jerusalem: but they brought him not into the sepulchres of the kings of Israel: and Hezekiah his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>Ahaz gathered together the vessels of the house of God and cut in pieces the vessels of the house of God. He shut up the doors of the house of the LORD. He made Himself altars in every corner of Jerusalem.</p> <p>In every city of Judah He made high places to make offerings to other gods, provoking to anger the LORD, the God of His fathers.</p> <p>Now the rest of His acts and all His ways, from first to last, they are written in the Book of the Kings of Judah and Israel.</p> <p>Ahaz slept with his fathers. They buried him in the city, in Jerusalem, for they did not bring him into the tombs of the kings of Israel. And Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Ex 34:17

v3 — 2 Chr 33:6; 2 Chr 33:2

v5 — Isa 7:1

v6 — Jer 15:6; Isa 1:28; Jer 2:19

v8 — 2 Chr 11:4

v9 — Rev 18:5; Ezra 9:6; Isa 47:6
v15 — Deut 34:3; Prov 25:21-22
v18 — Ezek 16:57
v19 — 2 Chr 21:2
v23 — 2 Chr 25:14

Hezekiah of Judah — 715–686 BC

Chapter 29

Hezekiah reopened the doors of the temple in the first month of his reign and commanded the priests and Levites to cleanse the house of the LORD. The temple was consecrated in sixteen days, and Hezekiah restored the burnt offerings and the worship of God with singing and rejoicing.

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| 1 | <i>Hezekiah began to reign when he was five and twenty years old, and he reigned nine and twenty years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Abijah, the daughter of Zechariah.</i> | Hezekiah began to reign when he was twenty-five years old. He reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abijah the daughter of Zechariah. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that David his father had done.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that David his father had done. |
| 3 | <i>He in the first year of his reign, in the first month, opened the doors of the house of the LORD, and repaired them.</i> | In the first year of His reign, in the first month, He opened the doors of the house of the LORD and repaired them. |
| 4 | <i>And he brought in the priests and the Levites, and gathered them together into the east street,</i> | He brought in the priests and the Levites and assembled them in the square on the east. |
| 5 | <i>And said unto them, Hear me, ye Levites, sanctify now yourselves, and sanctify the house of the LORD God of your fathers, and carry forth the filthiness out of the holy place.</i> | And said to them, "Hear me, Levites! Now consecrate yourselves, and consecrate the house of the LORD, the God of Your fathers, and carry out the filth from the holy place. |

- 6 *For our fathers have trespassed, and done that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD our God, and have forsaken him, and have turned away their faces from the habitation of the LORD, and turned their backs.* For our fathers have been unfaithful and have done what was evil in the sight of the LORD our God. They have forsaken Him and have turned away their faces from the habitation of the LORD and turned their backs.
- 7 *Also they have shut up the doors of the porch, and put out the lamps, and have not burned incense nor offered burnt offerings in the holy place unto the God of Israel.* They also shut the doors of the vestibule and put out the lamps and have not burned incense or offered burnt offerings in the holy place to the God of Israel.
- 8 *Wherefore the wrath of the LORD was upon Judah and Jerusalem, and he hath delivered them to trouble, to astonishment, and to hissing, as ye see with your eyes.* Therefore the wrath of the LORD came on Judah and Jerusalem. He has made them an object of horror, of astonishment, and of hissing, as You see with Your own eyes.
- 9 *For, lo, our fathers have fallen by the sword, and our sons and our daughters and our wives are in captivity for this.* For our fathers have fallen by the sword, and our sons and our daughters and our wives are in captivity for this.
- 10 *Now it is in mine heart to make a covenant with the LORD God of Israel, that his fierce wrath may turn away from us.* Now it is in my heart to make a covenant with the LORD, the God of Israel, so that His fierce anger may turn away from us.
- 11 *My sons, be not now negligent: for the LORD hath chosen you to stand before him, to serve him, and that ye should minister unto him, and burn incense.* My sons, do not now be negligent, for the LORD has chosen You to stand in His presence, to minister to Him and to be His ministers and make offerings to Him."

- 12 *Then the Levites arose, Mahath the son of Amasai, and Joel the son of Azariah, of the sons of the Kohathites; and of the sons of Merari, Kish the son of Abdi, and Azariah the son of Jehallelel: and of the Gershonites; Joah the son of Zimmah, and Eden the son of Joah:* Then the Levites arose: Mahath the son of Amasai and Joel the son of Azariah, of the sons of the Kohathites. Of the sons of Merari, Kish the son of Abdi and Azariah the son of Jehallelel. Of the Gershonites, Joah the son of Zimmah and Eden the son of Joah;
- 13 *And of the sons of Elizaphan; Shimri, and Jeiel: and of the sons of Asaph; Zechariah, and Mattaniah:* Of the sons of Elizaphan, Shimri and Jeiel. Of the sons of Asaph, Zechariah and Mattaniah;
- 14 *And of the sons of Heman; Jehiel, and Shimei: and of the sons of Jeduthun; Shemaiah, and Uzziel.* Of the sons of Heman, Jehiel and Shimei. Of the sons of Jeduthun, Shemaiah and Uzziel.
- 15 *And they gathered their brethren, and sanctified themselves, and came, according to the commandment of the king, by the words of the LORD, to cleanse the house of the LORD.* They gathered their brothers and consecrated themselves and went in as the king had commanded, by the words of the LORD, to cleanse the house of the LORD.
- 16 *And the priests went into the inner part of the house of the LORD, to cleanse it, and brought out all the uncleanness that they found in the temple of the LORD into the court of the house of the LORD. And the Levites took it, to carry it out abroad into the brook Kidron.* The priests went into the inner part of the house of the LORD to cleanse it. They brought out all the uncleanness that they found in the temple of the LORD into the court of the house of the LORD. And the Levites took it and carried it out to the brook Kidron.
- 17 *Now they began on the first day of the first month to sanctify, and on the eighth day of the month came they to the porch of the LORD: so they sanctified the house of the LORD in eight days; and in the sixteenth day of the first month they made an end.* They began to consecrate on the first day of the first month, and on the eighth day of the month they came to the vestibule of the LORD. Then for eight days they consecrated the house of the LORD, and on the sixteenth day of the first month they finished.

- 18 *Then they went in to Hezekiah the king, and said, We have cleansed all the house of the LORD, and the altar of burnt offering, with all the vessels thereof, and the shewbread table, with all the vessels thereof.* Then they went in to King Hezekiah and said, "We have cleansed all the house of the LORD, the altar of burnt offering and all its utensils, and the table for the bread of the Presence and all its utensils.
- 19 *Moreover all the vessels, which king Ahaz in his reign did cast away in his transgression, have we prepared and sanctified, and, behold, they are before the altar of the LORD.* All the vessels that King Ahaz discarded during his reign when he was faithless, we have made ready and consecrated. They are before the altar of the LORD."
- 20 *Then Hezekiah the king rose early, and gathered the rulers of the city, and went up to the house of the LORD.* Then Hezekiah the king rose early and gathered the officials of the city and went up to the house of the LORD.
- 21 *And they brought seven bullocks, and seven rams, and seven lambs, and seven he goats, for a sin offering for the kingdom, and for the sanctuary, and for Judah. And he commanded the priests the sons of Aaron to offer them on the altar of the LORD.* They brought seven bulls, seven rams, seven lambs, and seven male goats for a sin offering for the kingdom and for the sanctuary and for Judah. And He commanded the priests, the sons of Aaron, to offer them on the altar of the LORD.
- 22 *So they killed the bullocks, and the priests received the blood, and sprinkled it on the altar: likewise, when they had killed the rams, they sprinkled the blood upon the altar: they killed also the lambs, and they sprinkled the blood upon the altar.* So they slaughtered the bulls, and the priests received the blood and threw it against the altar. And they slaughtered the rams and their blood was thrown against the altar. And they slaughtered the lambs and their blood was thrown against the altar.
- 23 *And they brought forth the he goats for the sin offering before the king and the congregation; and they laid their hands upon them:* Then the male goats for the sin offering were brought before the king and the assembly. They laid their hands on them,

- 24 *And the priests killed them, and they made reconciliation with their blood upon the altar, to make an atonement for all Israel: for the king commanded that the burnt offering and the sin offering should be made for all Israel.* The priests slaughtered them and made a sin offering with their blood on the altar, to make atonement for all Israel. For the king commanded that the burnt offering and the sin offering should be made for all Israel.
- 25 *And he set the Levites in the house of the LORD with cymbals, with psalteries, and with harps, according to the commandment of David, and of Gad the king's seer, and Nathan the prophet: for so was the commandment of the LORD by his prophets.* He stationed the Levites in the house of the LORD with cymbals, harps, and lyres, according to the commandment of David and of Gad the king's seer and of Nathan the prophet, for the commandment was from the LORD through His prophets.
- 26 *And the Levites stood with the instruments of David, and the priests with the trumpets.* The Levites stood with the instruments of David, and the priests with the trumpets.
- 27 *And Hezekiah commanded to offer the burnt offering upon the altar. And when the burnt offering began, the song of the LORD began also with the trumpets, and with the instruments ordained by David king of Israel.* Then Hezekiah commanded that the burnt offering be offered on the altar. And when the burnt offering began, the song to the LORD began also, and the trumpets, accompanied by the instruments of David king of Israel.
- 28 *And all the congregation worshipped, and the singers sang, and the trumpeters sounded: and all this continued until the burnt offering was finished.* All the assembly worshiped, and the singers sang, and the trumpeters sounded. All this continued until the burnt offering was finished.
- 29 *And when they had made an end of offering, the king and all that were present with him bowed themselves, and worshipped.* When the offering was finished, the king and all who were present with him bowed themselves and worshiped.

- 30 *Moreover Hezekiah the king and the princes commanded the Levites to sing praise unto the LORD with the words of David, and of Asaph the seer. And they sang praises with gladness, and they bowed their heads and worshipped.* Hezekiah the king and the princes commanded the Levites to sing praises to the LORD with the words of David and of Asaph the seer. And they sang praises with gladness. They bowed down and worshiped.
- 31 *Then Hezekiah answered and said, Now ye have consecrated yourselves unto the LORD, come near and bring sacrifices and thank offerings into the house of the LORD. And the congregation brought in sacrifices and thank offerings; and as many as were of a free heart burnt offerings.* Then Hezekiah said, "Now you have consecrated yourselves to the LORD. Come near; bring sacrifices and thank offerings to the house of the LORD." And the assembly brought sacrifices and thank offerings. All who were of a willing heart brought burnt offerings.
- 32 *And the number of the burnt offerings, which the congregation brought, was threescore and ten bullocks, an hundred rams, and two hundred lambs: all these were for a burnt offering to the LORD.* The number of the burnt offerings that the assembly brought was seventy bulls, one hundred rams, and two hundred lambs; all these were for a burnt offering to the LORD.
- 33 *And the consecrated things were six hundred oxen and three thousand sheep.* The consecrated offerings were six hundred bulls and three thousand sheep.
- 34 *But the priests were too few, so that they could not flay all the burnt offerings: wherefore their brethren the Levites did help them, till the work was ended, and until the other priests had sanctified themselves: for the Levites were more upright in heart to sanctify themselves than the priests.* But the priests were too few and could not flay all the burnt offerings, so until other priests had consecrated themselves, their brothers the Levites helped them, until the work was finished — for the Levites were more upright in heart than the priests in consecrating themselves.

- 35 *And also the burnt offerings were in abundance, with the fat of the peace offerings, and the drink offerings for every burnt offering. So the service of the house of the LORD was set in order.* Besides the great number of burnt offerings, there was the fat of the peace offerings, and there were the drink offerings for the burnt offerings. Thus the service of the house of the LORD was restored.
- 36 *And Hezekiah rejoiced, and all the people, that God had prepared the people: for the thing was done suddenly.* Hezekiah and all the people rejoiced because God had prepared the people, for the thing came about suddenly.

Words in this chapter:

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

Gad (GAD) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Eden (EE-den) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Cross-References:

v3 — 2 Chr 28:24

v5 — 2 Chr 35:6

v6 — Ezek 8:16; Jer 2:27

v7 — 2 Chr 28:24

v8 — Jer 25:9; Jer 25:18

v9 — 2 Chr 28:17

v10 — Jer 50:5; 2 Chr 23:16

v15 — 2 Chr 30:12; 1 Chr 23:28

v19 — 2 Chr 28:24

v23 — Lev 4:15

v25 — 2 Chr 8:14; 1 Chr 23:5

v26 — 1 Chr 23:5

Chapter 30

Hezekiah invited all Israel and Judah to keep the Passover at Jerusalem; many from the north mocked the messengers, but some humbled themselves and came. They kept the feast for fourteen days with great joy — nothing like it since the days of Solomon.

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| <p>1 <i>And Hezekiah sent to all Israel and Judah, and wrote letters also to Ephraim and Manasseh, that they should come to the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, to keep the passover unto the LORD God of Israel.</i></p> <p>2 <i>For the king had taken counsel, and his princes, and all the congregation in Jerusalem, to keep the passover in the second month.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For they could not keep it at that time, because the priests had not sanctified themselves sufficiently, neither had the people gathered themselves together to Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And the thing pleased the king and all the congregation.</i></p> <p>5 <i>So they established a decree to make proclamation throughout all Israel, from Beersheba even to Dan, that they should come to keep the passover unto the LORD God of Israel at Jerusalem: for they had not done it of a long time in such sort as it was written.</i></p> <p>6 <i>So the posts went with the letters from the king and his princes throughout all Israel and Judah, and according to the commandment of the king, saying, Ye children of Israel, turn again unto the LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, and he will return to the remnant of you, that are escaped out of the hand of the kings of Assyria.</i></p> | <p>Hezekiah sent to all Israel and Judah, and wrote letters also to Ephraim and Manasseh, that they should come to the house of the LORD at Jerusalem to keep the Passover to the LORD, the God of Israel.</p> <p>For the king and his princes and all the assembly in Jerusalem had taken counsel to keep the Passover in the second month —</p> <p>For they could not keep it at that time because the priests had not consecrated themselves in sufficient number, nor had the people assembled in Jerusalem.</p> <p>The plan seemed right to the king and all the assembly.</p> <p>So they decreed to make a proclamation throughout all Israel, from Beersheba to Dan, that the people should come and keep the Passover to the LORD, the God of Israel, at Jerusalem, for they had not kept it as often as prescribed.</p> <p>So the couriers went throughout all Israel and Judah with letters from the king and his princes, as the king had commanded, saying, "O people of Israel, return to the LORD, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, that he may turn again to the remnant of You who have escaped from the hand of the kings of Assyria.</p> |
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- 7 *And be not ye like your fathers, and like your brethren, which trespassed against the LORD God of their fathers, who therefore gave them up to desolation, as ye see.* Do not be like Your fathers and Your brothers, who were faithless to the LORD God of their fathers, so that He made them a desolation, as You see.
- 8 *Now be ye not stiffnecked, as your fathers were, but yield yourselves unto the LORD, and enter into his sanctuary, which he hath sanctified for ever: and serve the LORD your God, that the fierceness of his wrath may turn away from you.* Do not now be stiff-necked as Your fathers were, but yield yourselves to the LORD and come to His sanctuary, which He has consecrated forever, and serve the LORD Your God, so that His fierce anger may turn away from You.
- 9 *For if ye turn again unto the LORD, your brethren and your children shall find compassion before them that lead them captive, so that they shall come again into this land: for the LORD your God is gracious and merciful, and will not turn away his face from you, if ye return unto him.* For if You return to the LORD, Your brothers and Your children will find compassion with their captors and return to this land. For the LORD Your God is gracious and merciful and will not turn away His face from You, if You return to Him."
- 10 *So the posts passed from city to city through the country of Ephraim and Manasseh even unto Zebulun: but they laughed them to scorn, and mocked them.* So the couriers went from city to city through the country of Ephraim and Manasseh, and as far as Zebulun. But they laughed them to scorn and mocked them.
- 11 *Nevertheless divers of Asher and Manasseh and of Zebulun humbled themselves, and came to Jerusalem.* However, some men of Asher, of Manasseh, and of Zebulun humbled themselves and came to Jerusalem.
- 12 *Also in Judah the hand of God was to give them one heart to do the commandment of the king and of the princes, by the word of the LORD.* The hand of God was also on Judah to give them one heart to do what the king and the princes commanded by the word of the LORD.

- 13 *And there assembled at Jerusalem much people to keep the feast of unleavened bread in the second month, a very great congregation.* Many people came together in Jerusalem to keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread in the second month, a very great assembly.
- 14 *And they arose and took away the altars that were in Jerusalem, and all the altars for incense took they away, and cast them into the brook Kidron.* They set to work and removed the altars that were in Jerusalem. All the altars for burning incense they took away and threw into the brook Kidron.
- 15 *Then they killed the passover on the fourteenth day of the second month: and the priests and the Levites were ashamed, and sanctified themselves, and brought in the burnt offerings into the house of the LORD.* They slaughtered the Passover lamb on the fourteenth day of the second month. And the priests and the Levites were ashamed, so they consecrated themselves and brought burnt offerings into the house of the LORD.
- 16 *And they stood in their place after their manner, according to the law of Moses the man of God: the priests sprinkled the blood, which they received of the hand of the Levites.* They took their accustomed posts according to the Law of Moses the man of God. The priests threw the blood that they received from the hand of the Levites.
- 17 *For there were many in the congregation that were not sanctified: therefore the Levites had the charge of the killing of the passovers for every one that was not clean, to sanctify them unto the LORD.* For there were many in the assembly who had not consecrated themselves. Therefore the Levites had to slaughter the Passover lamb for everyone who was not clean, to consecrate it to the LORD.
- 18 *For a multitude of the people, even many of Ephraim, and Manasseh, Issachar, and Zebulun, had not cleansed themselves, yet did they eat the passover otherwise than it was written. But Hezekiah prayed for them, saying, The good LORD pardon every one* For a majority of the people, many of them from Ephraim, Manasseh, Issachar, and Zebulun, had not cleansed themselves, yet they ate the Passover otherwise than as prescribed. For Hezekiah had prayed for them, saying, "May the good LORD pardon everyone

- 19 *That prepareth his heart to seek God, the LORD God of his fathers, though he be not cleansed according to the purification of the sanctuary.* Who sets His heart to seek God, the LORD, the God of His fathers, even though not according to the sanctuary's rules of cleanness."
- 20 *And the LORD hearkened to Hezekiah, and healed the people.* The LORD heard Hezekiah and healed the people.
- 21 *And the children of Israel that were present at Jerusalem kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with great gladness: and the Levites and the priests praised the LORD day by day, singing with loud instruments unto the LORD.* The people of Israel who were present at Jerusalem kept the Feast of Unleavened Bread seven days with great gladness, and the Levites and the priests praised the LORD day by day, singing with all their might to the LORD.
- 22 *And Hezekiah spake comfortably unto all the Levites that taught the good knowledge of the LORD: and they did eat throughout the feast seven days, offering peace offerings, and making confession to the LORD God of their fathers.* Hezekiah spoke encouragingly to all the Levites who showed good skill in the service of the LORD. So they ate the food of the festival for seven days, sacrificing peace offerings and giving thanks to the LORD, the God of their fathers.
- 23 *And the whole assembly took counsel to keep other seven days: and they kept other seven days with gladness.* Then the whole assembly agreed together to keep the feast for another seven days. So they kept it for another seven days with gladness.
- 24 *For Hezekiah king of Judah did give to the congregation a thousand bullocks and seven thousand sheep; and the princes gave to the congregation a thousand bullocks and ten thousand sheep: and a great number of priests sanctified themselves.* For Hezekiah king of Judah gave the assembly one thousand bulls and seven thousand sheep for offerings, and the princes gave the assembly one thousand bulls and ten thousand sheep. And the priests consecrated themselves in great numbers.

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| <p>25 <i>And all the congregation of Judah, with the priests and the Levites, and all the congregation that came out of Israel, and the strangers that came out of the land of Israel, and that dwelt in Judah, rejoiced.</i></p> <p>26 <i>So there was great joy in Jerusalem: for since the time of Solomon the son of David king of Israel there was not the like in Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Then the priests the Levites arose and blessed the people: and their voice was heard, and their prayer came up to his holy dwelling place, even unto heaven.</i></p> | <p>The whole assembly of Judah, and the priests and the Levites, and the whole assembly that came out of Israel, and the sojourners who came out of the land of Israel, and the sojourners who lived in Judah, rejoiced.</p> <p>So there was great joy in Jerusalem, for since the time of Solomon the son of David king of Israel there had been nothing like this in Jerusalem.</p> <p>Then the priests and the Levites arose and blessed the people. Their voice was heard. Their prayer came to his holy habitation in heaven.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Cross-References:

v3 — 2 Chr 29:34

v6 — Jer 51:31

v8 — 2 Chr 29:10; Ex 32:9

v9 — Isa 55:7; Mic 7:18; Ps 86:5; Ps 106:46; Deut 30:2-4

v10 — 2 Chr 36:16

v12 — Jer 32:39; Jer 24:7; Phil 2:13

v15 — 2 Chr 29:34

v17 — 2 Chr 29:34

v18 — 1 Cor 11:28; Jas 5:15-16

v19 — 2 Chr 19:3; Prov 23:26

v21 — Ex 12:15; Ex 13:6

v27 — Deut 26:15; Ps 68:5

Chapter 31

After the Passover, the people went out and destroyed the idols and high places throughout Judah, Benjamin, Ephraim, and Manasseh. Hezekiah organized the priestly divisions and the people brought tithes and offerings in such abundance that heaps were piled up.

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| <p>1 <i>Now when all this was finished, all Israel that were present went out to the cities of Judah, and brake the images in pieces, and cut down the groves, and threw down the high places and the altars out of all Judah and Benjamin, in Ephraim also and Manasseh, until they had utterly destroyed them all. Then all the children of Israel returned, every man to his possession, into their own cities.</i></p> | <p>Now when all this was finished, all Israel who were present went out to the cities of Judah and broke in pieces the images and cut down the groves and threw down the high places and the altars throughout all Judah and Benjamin, and in Ephraim and Manasseh, until they had utterly destroyed them all. Then all the children of Israel returned, every man to his possession, into their own cities.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And Hezekiah appointed the courses of the priests and the Levites after their courses, every man according to his service, the priests and Levites for burnt offerings and for peace offerings, to minister, and to give thanks, and to praise in the gates of the tents of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Hezekiah appointed the divisions of the priests and of the Levites, division by division, each according to His service, the priests and the Levites, for burnt offerings and peace offerings, to minister in the gates of the camp of the LORD and to give thanks and praise.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>He appointed also the king's portion of his substance for the burnt offerings, to wit, for the morning and evening burnt offerings, and the burnt offerings for the sabbaths, and for the new moons, and for the set feasts, as it is written in the law of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>The contribution of the king from his own possessions was for the burnt offerings: the burnt offerings of morning and evening, and the burnt offerings for the Sabbaths, the new moons, and the appointed feasts, as it is written in the Law of the LORD.</p> |

- 4 *Moreover he commanded the people that dwelt in Jerusalem to give the portion of the priests and the Levites, that they might be encouraged in the law of the LORD.* He commanded the people who lived in Jerusalem to give the portion due to the priests and the Levites, that they might give themselves to the Law of the LORD.
- 5 *And as soon as the commandment came abroad, the children of Israel brought in abundance the firstfruits of corn, wine, and oil, and honey, and of all the increase of the field; and the tithe of all things brought they in abundantly.* As soon as the command was spread abroad, the people of Israel gave in abundance the firstfruits of grain, wine, oil, honey, and of all the produce of the field. And they brought in abundantly the tithe of everything.
- 6 *And concerning the children of Israel and Judah, that dwelt in the cities of Judah, they also brought in the tithe of oxen and sheep, and the tithe of holy things which were consecrated unto the LORD their God, and laid them by heaps.* The people of Israel and Judah who lived in the cities of Judah also brought in the tithe of cattle and sheep, and the tithe of the dedicated things that had been dedicated to the LORD their God, and laid them in heaps.
- 7 *In the third month they began to lay the foundation of the heaps, and finished them in the seventh month.* In the third month they began to pile up the heaps, and finished them in the seventh month.
- 8 *And when Hezekiah and the princes came and saw the heaps, they blessed the LORD, and his people Israel.* When Hezekiah and the princes came and saw the heaps, they blessed the LORD and His people Israel.
- 9 *Then Hezekiah questioned with the priests and the Levites concerning the heaps.* Hezekiah questioned the priests and the Levites about the heaps.

- 10 *And Azariah the chief priest of the house of Zadok answered him, and said, Since the people began to bring the offerings into the house of the LORD, we have had enough to eat, and have left plenty: for the LORD hath blessed his people; and that which is left is this great store.* Azariah the chief priest, who was of the house of Zadok, answered Him, "Since they began to bring the contributions into the house of the LORD, we have eaten and had enough and have plenty left, for the LORD has blessed His people, so that we have this large amount left."
- 11 *Then Hezekiah commanded to prepare chambers in the house of the LORD; and they prepared them,* Then Hezekiah commanded them to prepare chambers in the house of the LORD. They prepared them.
- 12 *And brought in the offerings and the tithes and the dedicated things faithfully: over which Cononiah the Levite was ruler, and Shimei his brother was the next.* They faithfully brought in the contributions, the tithes, and the dedicated things. The chief officer in charge of them was Conaniah the Levite, with Shimei his brother as second.
- 13 *And Jehiel, and Azaziah, and Nahath, and Asahel, and Jerimoth, and Jozabad, and Eliel, and Ismachiah, and Mahath, and Benaiah, were overseers under the hand of Cononiah and Shimei his brother, at the commandment of Hezekiah the king, and Azariah the ruler of the house of God.* Jehiel, Azaziah, Nahath, Asahel, Jerimoth, Jozabad, Eliel, Ismachiah, Mahath, and Benaiah were overseers assisting Conaniah and Shimei his brother, by the appointment of King Hezekiah and Azariah the chief officer of the house of God.
- 14 *And Kore the son of Imnah the Levite, the porter toward the east, was over the freewill offerings of God, to distribute the oblations of the LORD, and the most holy things.* Kore the son of Imnah the Levite, keeper of the east gate, was over the freewill offerings to God, to apportion the contribution reserved for the LORD and the most holy offerings.

- 15 *And next him were Eden, and Miniamin, and Jeshua, and Shemaiah, Amariah, and Shecaniah, in the cities of the priests, in their set office, to give to their brethren by courses, as well to the great as to the small:* Eden, Miniamin, Jeshua, Shemaiah, Amariah, and Shecaniah were faithfully assisting Him in the cities of the priests, to distribute the portions to their brothers, old and young alike, by divisions,
- 16 *Beside their genealogy of males, from three years old and upward, even unto every one that entereth into the house of the LORD, his daily portion for their service in their charges according to their courses;* Except those enrolled by genealogy, males from three years old and upward — all who entered the house of the LORD as the duty of each day required — for their service according to their offices, by their divisions.
- 17 *Both to the genealogy of the priests by the house of their fathers, and the Levites from twenty years old and upward, in their charges by their courses;* The enrollment of the priests was according to their fathers' houses; that of the Levites from twenty years old and upward was according to their offices, by their divisions.
- 18 *And to the genealogy of all their little ones, their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, through all the congregation: for in their set office they sanctified themselves in holiness:* The enrollment included all their little children, their wives, their sons. Their daughters, the whole crowd, for they were faithful in consecrating themselves in holiness.
- 19 *Also of the sons of Aaron the priests, which were in the fields of the suburbs of their cities, in every several city, the men that were expressed by name, to give portions to all the males among the priests, and to all that were reckoned by genealogies among the Levites.* For the sons of Aaron, the priests, who were in the fields of the pasturelands of their cities, or in each and every city, there were men who were designated by name to distribute portions to every male among the priests and to everyone among the Levites who was enrolled.
- 20 *And thus did Hezekiah throughout all Judah, and wrought that which was good and right and truth before the LORD his God.* Thus Hezekiah did throughout all Judah. He did what was good and right and faithful before the LORD His God.

- 21

And in every work that he began in the service of the house of God, and in the law, and in the commandments, to seek his God, he did it with all his heart, and prospered.
- Every work that He undertook in the service of the house of God and in accordance with the law and the commandments, seeking His God, He did with all His heart. He prospered.

Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Kgs 18:4
- v3 — Ezek 45:17
- v4 — Mal 2:7; Num 18:8-21
- v5 — Neh 13:12
- v6 — Lev 27:30
- v10 — Mal 3:10; 1 Chr 6:8
- v15 — Josh 21:9-19
- v19 — 2 Chr 31:12-15
- v20 — 2 Kgs 20:3; 2 Kgs 22:2
- v21 — Matt 6:33; Jer 29:13; Josh 1:7-8; Deut 6:5; Matt 7:24-27

Chapter 32

Sennacherib king of Assyria invaded Judah; Hezekiah fortified Jerusalem, stopped the springs, and encouraged the people to trust the LORD. God sent an angel who destroyed the Assyrian army, and Sennacherib returned home in disgrace and was murdered by his own sons.

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After these things, and the establishment thereof, Sennacherib king of Assyria came, and entered into Judah, and encamped against the fenced cities, and thought to win them for himself.
- After these things and these acts of faithfulness, Sennacherib king of Assyria came and invaded Judah and encamped against the fortified cities, thinking to win them for Himself.
- 2

And when Hezekiah saw that Sennacherib was come, and that he was purposed to fight against Jerusalem,
- When Hezekiah saw that Sennacherib had come and intended to fight against Jerusalem,

- 3 *He took counsel with his princes and his mighty men to stop the waters of the fountains which were without the city: and they did help him.* He planned with his officers and his mighty men to stop the water of the springs that were outside the city. They helped him.
- 4 *So there was gathered much people together, who stopped all the fountains, and the brook that ran through the midst of the land, saying, Why should the kings of Assyria come, and find much water?* A great many people were gathered. They stopped all the springs and the brook that flowed through the land, saying, "Why should the kings of Assyria come and find much water?"
- 5 *Also he strengthened himself, and built up all the wall that was broken, and raised it up to the towers, and another wall without, and repaired Millo in the city of David, and made darts and shields in abundance.* He set to work resolutely and built up all the wall that was broken down and raised towers on it, and outside it he built another wall. He strengthened the Millo in the city of David. He also made weapons and shields in abundance.
- 6 *And he set captains of war over the people, and gathered them together to him in the street of the gate of the city, and spake comfortably to them, saying,* He set combat commanders over the people and gathered them together to him in the square at the gate of the city and spoke encouragingly to them, saying,
- 7 *Be strong and courageous, be not afraid nor dismayed for the king of Assyria, nor for all the multitude that is with him: for there be more with us than with him:* "Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid or dismayed before the king of Assyria and all the horde that is with him, for there are more with us than with him.
- 8 *With him is an arm of flesh; but with us is the LORD our God to help us, and to fight our battles. And the people rested themselves upon the words of Hezekiah king of Judah.* With Him is an arm of flesh, but with us is the LORD our God, to help us and to fight our battles." And the people took confidence from the words of Hezekiah king of Judah.

- 9 *After this did Sennacherib king of Assyria send his servants to Jerusalem, (but he himself laid siege against Lachish, and all his power with him,) unto Hezekiah king of Judah, and unto all Judah that were at Jerusalem, saying,* After this, Sennacherib king of Assyria, who was besieging Lachish with all his forces, sent his servants to Jerusalem to Hezekiah king of Judah and to all Judah who were in Jerusalem, saying,
- 10 *Thus saith Sennacherib king of Assyria, Whereon do ye trust, that ye abide in the siege in Jerusalem?* "Thus says Sennacherib king of Assyria, 'On what are you trusting, that you endure the siege in Jerusalem?
- 11 *Doth not Hezekiah persuade you to give over yourselves to die by famine and by thirst, saying, The LORD our God shall deliver us out of the hand of the king of Assyria?* Is not Hezekiah misleading you, that he may give you over to die by famine and by thirst, when He tells You, "The LORD our God will deliver us from the hand of the king of Assyria"?
- 12 *Hath not the same Hezekiah taken away his high places and his altars, and commanded Judah and Jerusalem, saying, Ye shall worship before one altar, and burn incense upon it?* Has not this same Hezekiah taken away his high places and his altars and commanded Judah and Jerusalem, "Before one altar you shall worship, and on it you shall make your offerings"?
- 13 *Know ye not what I and my fathers have done unto all the people of other lands? were the gods of the nations of those lands any ways able to deliver their lands out of mine hand?* Do you not know what I and my fathers have done to all the peoples of other lands? Were the gods of the nations of those lands at all able to deliver their lands out of my hand?
- 14 *Who was there among all the gods of those nations that my fathers utterly destroyed, that could deliver his people out of mine hand, that your God should be able to deliver you out of mine hand?* Who among all the gods of those nations that my fathers devoted to destruction was able to deliver his people from my hand, that your God should be able to deliver you from my hand?

- 15 *Now therefore let not Hezekiah deceive you, nor persuade you on this manner, neither yet believe him: for no god of any nation or kingdom was able to deliver his people out of mine hand, and out of the hand of my fathers: how much less shall your God deliver you out of mine hand?* Now, therefore, do not let Hezekiah deceive you or mislead you in this fashion, and do not believe him, for no god of any nation or kingdom has been able to deliver His people from my hand or from the hand of my fathers. How much less will your God deliver you out of my hand!"
- 16 *And his servants spake yet more against the LORD God, and against his servant Hezekiah.* His servants said still more against the LORD God and against His servant Hezekiah.
- 17 *He wrote also letters to rail on the LORD God of Israel, and to speak against him, saying, As the gods of the nations of other lands have not delivered their people out of mine hand, so shall not the God of Hezekiah deliver his people out of mine hand.* He wrote letters to cast contempt on the LORD, the God of Israel, and to speak against Him, saying, "Like the gods of the nations of the lands who have not delivered their people from my hands, so the God of Hezekiah will not deliver his people from my hand."
- 18 *Then they cried with a loud voice in the Jews' speech unto the people of Jerusalem that were on the wall, to affright them, and to trouble them; that they might take the city.* They shouted it with a loud voice in the language of Judah to the people of Jerusalem who were on the wall, to frighten and terrify them, in order that they might take the city.
- 19 *And they spake against the God of Jerusalem, as against the gods of the people of the earth, which were the work of the hands of man.* They spoke of the God of Jerusalem as they spoke of the gods of the peoples of the earth, which are the work of men's hands.
- 20 *And for this cause Hezekiah the king, and the prophet Isaiah the son of Amoz, prayed and cried to heaven.* Then Hezekiah the king and Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, prayed because of this and cried to heaven.

- 21 *And the LORD sent an angel, which cut off all the mighty men of valour, and the leaders and captains in the camp of the king of Assyria. So he returned with shame of face to his own land. And when he was come into the house of his god, they that came forth of his own bowels slew him there with the sword.* The LORD sent an angel, who cut off all the mighty warriors and commanders and officers in the camp of the king of Assyria. So he returned with shame of face to His own land. And when He came into the house of His god, some of His own sons struck Him down there with the sword.
- 22 *Thus the LORD saved Hezekiah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherib the king of Assyria, and from the hand of all other, and guided them on every side.* So the LORD saved Hezekiah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherib king of Assyria and from the hand of all His enemies. He provided for them on every side.
- 23 *And many brought gifts unto the LORD to Jerusalem, and presents to Hezekiah king of Judah: so that he was magnified in the sight of all nations from thenceforth.* Many brought gifts to the LORD to Jerusalem and precious things to Hezekiah king of Judah, so that he was exalted in the sight of all nations from that time onward.
- 24 *In those days Hezekiah was sick to the death, and prayed unto the LORD: and he spake unto him, and he gave him a sign.* In those days Hezekiah became sick and was at the point of death. He prayed to the LORD. He answered Him and gave Him a sign.
- 25 *But Hezekiah rendered not again according to the benefit done unto him; for his heart was lifted up: therefore there was wrath upon him, and upon Judah and Jerusalem.* But Hezekiah did not make return according to the benefit done to him, for his heart was proud. Therefore wrath came upon him and Judah and Jerusalem.
- 26 *Notwithstanding Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both he and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that the wrath of the LORD came not upon them in the days of Hezekiah.* But Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both He and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that the wrath of the LORD did not come upon them in the days of Hezekiah.

- 27 *And Hezekiah had exceeding much riches and honour: and he made himself treasuries for silver, and for gold, and for precious stones, and for spices, and for shields, and for all manner of pleasant jewels;* Hezekiah had very great riches and honor. He made for himself treasuries for silver, gold, precious stones, spices, shields, and all kinds of desirable objects;
- 28 *Storehouses also for the increase of corn, and wine, and oil; and stalls for all manner of beasts, and cotes for flocks.* Storehouses also for the yield of grain, wine, and oil, and stalls for all kinds of cattle, and sheepfolds.
- 29 *Moreover he provided him cities, and possessions of flocks and herds in abundance: for God had given him substance very much.* He likewise provided cities for himself and flocks and herds in abundance, for God had given him very great possessions.
- 30 *This same Hezekiah also stopped the upper watercourse of Gihon, and brought it straight down to the west side of the city of David. And Hezekiah prospered in all his works.* This same Hezekiah closed the upper outlet of the waters of Gihon and directed them down to the west side of the city of David. And Hezekiah prospered in all his works.
- 31 *Howbeit in the business of the ambassadors of the princes of Babylon, who sent unto him to enquire of the wonder that was done in the land, God left him, to try him, that he might know all that was in his heart.* So in the matter of the envoys of the princes of Babylon, who had been sent to him to inquire about the sign that had been done in the land, God left Him to himself, in order to test Him and to know all that was in His heart.
- 32 *Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and his goodness, behold, they are written in the vision of Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, and in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah and his good deeds, they are written in the vision of Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz, in the Book of the Kings of Judah and Israel.

- 33 *And Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the chiefest of the sepulchres of the sons of David: and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem did him honour at his death. And Manasseh his son reigned in his stead.*
- Hezekiah slept with his fathers. They buried him in the upper part of the tombs of the sons of David. All Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem did him honor at his death. And Manasseh his son reigned in his place.

Words in this chapter:

- Hezekiah** (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'
- Isaiah** (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'
- Assyria** (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v5 — 2 Chr 25:23
- v7 — 2 Kgs 6:16; Rom 8:31; Eph 6:10; 2 Kgs 18:30; 1 John 4:4
- v8 — Jer 17:5; 2 Chr 20:17; Acts 18:10; 2 Tim 4:17; 2 Chr 20:15
- v12 — 2 Chr 31:1
- v20 — Ps 91:14-15
- v24 — 2 Kgs 20:1-11; Isa 38:1-8; Isa 38:21-22
- v25 — 2 Chr 24:18; 2 Chr 26:16
- v26 — Jer 26:18-19
- v30 — 1 Kgs 1:33
- v31 — Deut 8:2; Prov 17:3; John 15:5; 2 Chr 32:24; Gen 22:1

Manasseh of Judah — 686–642 BC

Amon of Judah — 642–640 BC

Chapter 33

Manasseh reigned fifty-five years and committed the worst abominations of any king, rebuilding the high places and setting up idols in the temple. God allowed him to be captured by Assyria; in his affliction he repented, and God restored him. His son Amon reigned wickedly and was assassinated.

- 1 *Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty and five years in Jerusalem:* Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign. He reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Manasseh** (muh-NASS-uh) — "causing to forget" — The son of Hezekiah who became the most wicked king of Judah, reigning fifty-five years. He rebuilt the high places, set up idol altars in the temple, and practiced sorcery. Yet after God allowed Assyria to capture him, he repented in prison, and God restored him to his throne — a remarkable picture of grace.

- 2 *But did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, like unto the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD had cast out before the children of Israel.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to the abominations of the nations whom the LORD drove out before the people of Israel.
- 3 *For he built again the high places which Hezekiah his father had broken down, and he reared up altars for Baalim, and made groves, and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served them.* For he rebuilt the high places that his father Hezekiah had broken down. He erected altars to the Baals, and made groves, and worshipped all the host of heaven and served them.
- 4 *Also he built altars in the house of the LORD, whereof the LORD had said, In Jerusalem shall my name be for ever.* He built altars in the house of the LORD, of which the LORD had said, "In Jerusalem shall my name be forever."
- 5 *And he built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD.* He built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD.
- 6 *And he caused his children to pass through the fire in the valley of the son of Hinnom: also he observed times, and used enchantments, and used witchcraft, and dealt with a familiar spirit, and with wizards: he wrought much evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.* He caused His children to pass through the fire in the Valley of the Son of Hinnom. He also observed times, and used enchantments, and used witchcraft, and dealt with a familiar spirit, and with wizards. He did much evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger.

- 7 *And he set a carved image, the idol which he had made, in the house of God, of which God had said to David and to Solomon his son, In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen before all the tribes of Israel, will I put my name for ever:* The carved image of the idol that he had made he set in the house of God, of which God said to David and to Solomon his son, "In this house and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever,
- 8 *Neither will I any more remove the foot of Israel from out of the land which I have appointed for your fathers; so that they will take heed to do all that I have commanded them, according to the whole law and the statutes and the ordinances by the hand of Moses.* I will no more remove the foot of Israel from the land that I appointed for your fathers, if only they will be careful to do all that I have commanded them, all the law, the statutes, and the rules given through Moses."
- 9 *So Manasseh made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem to err, and to do worse than the heathen, whom the LORD had destroyed before the children of Israel.* Manasseh led Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem astray, to do more evil than the nations whom the LORD destroyed before the people of Israel.
- 10 *And the LORD spake to Manasseh, and to his people: but they would not hearken.* The LORD spoke to Manasseh and to his people. But they paid no attention.
- 11 *Wherefore the LORD brought upon them the captains of the host of the king of Assyria, which took Manasseh among the thorns, and bound him with fetters, and carried him to Babylon.* Therefore the LORD brought upon them the commanders of the army of the king of Assyria, who captured Manasseh with hooks and bound him with chains of bronze and brought Him to Babylon.
- 12 *And when he was in affliction, he besought the LORD his God, and humbled himself greatly before the God of his fathers,* When He was in distress, He entreated the favor of the LORD His God and humbled Himself greatly before the God of His fathers.

- 13 *And prayed unto him: and he was intreated of him, and heard his supplication, and brought him again to Jerusalem into his kingdom. Then Manasseh knew that the LORD he was God.* He prayed to Him. God was moved by His entreaty and heard His plea and brought Him again to Jerusalem into His kingdom. Then Manasseh knew that the LORD was God.
- 14 *Now after this he built a wall without the city of David, on the west side of Gihon, in the valley, even to the entering in at the fish gate, and compassed about Ophel, and raised it up a very great height, and put captains of war in all the fenced cities of Judah.* Afterward he built an outer wall for the city of David west of Gihon, in the valley, and for the entrance into the Fish Gate, and carried it around Ophel, and raised it to a very great height. He also put commanders of the army in all the fortified cities in Judah.
- 15 *And he took away the strange gods, and the idol out of the house of the LORD, and all the altars that he had built in the mount of the house of the LORD, and in Jerusalem, and cast them out of the city.* He took away the foreign gods and the idol from the house of the LORD, and all the altars that He had built in the mount of the house of the LORD and in Jerusalem, and cast them out of the city.
- 16 *And he repaired the altar of the LORD, and sacrificed thereon peace offerings and thank offerings, and commanded Judah to serve the LORD God of Israel.* He also restored the altar of the LORD and offered on it sacrifices of peace offerings and of thanksgiving. He commanded Judah to serve the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 17 *Nevertheless the people did sacrifice still in the high places, yet unto the LORD their God only.* Nevertheless, the people still sacrificed at the high places, but only to the LORD their God.
- 18 *Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and his prayer unto his God, and the words of the seers that spake to him in the name of the LORD God of Israel, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel.* Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and his prayer to his God, and the words of the seers who spoke to Him in the name of the LORD, the God of Israel, they are in the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

- 19 *His prayer also, and how God was intreated of him, and all his sin, and his trespass, and the places wherein he built high places, and set up groves and graven images, before he was humbled: behold, they are written among the sayings of the seers.* His prayer also, and how God was moved by His entreaty, and all His sin and His trespass, and the places where He built high places and set up the groves and the graven images before He humbled Himself, they are written in the Chronicles of the Seers.
- 20 *So Manasseh slept with his fathers, and they buried him in his own house: and Amon his son reigned in his stead.* So Manasseh slept with his fathers. They buried him in his house. And Amon his son reigned in his place.
- 21 *Amon was two and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned two years in Jerusalem.* Amon was twenty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned two years in Jerusalem.
- 22 *But he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as did Manasseh his father: for Amon sacrificed unto all the carved images which Manasseh his father had made, and served them;* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD, as Manasseh his father had done. Amon sacrificed to all the images that Manasseh his father had made, and served them.
- 23 *And humbled not himself before the LORD, as Manasseh his father had humbled himself; but Amon trespassed more and more.* He did not humble Himself before the LORD, as Manasseh his father had humbled himself, but this Amon incurred guilt more and more.
- 24 *And his servants conspired against him, and slew him in his own house.* His servants conspired against him and put him to death in His house.
- 25 *But the people of the land slew all them that had conspired against king Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his stead.* But the people of the land struck down all those who had conspired against King Amon. And the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his place.

Words in this chapter:

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Chr 28:3
- v3 — Deut 16:21; Deut 17:3; 2 Chr 31:1
- v4 — 2 Chr 7:16
- v5 — 2 Chr 4:9
- v8 — 2 Sam 7:10
- v11 — Deut 28:36
- v12 — Ex 10:3; 2 Chr 32:26; Ps 50:15; Luke 18:14-15
- v13 — 1 Chr 5:20; Dan 4:25; Ezra 8:23; Matt 6:33; Matt 7:7-8
- v14 — Neh 3:3; 2 Chr 27:3; 1 Kgs 1:33
- v17 — 2 Chr 32:12
- v19 — 1 John 1:9; Acts 9:11
- v23 — 2 Chr 33:12

Josiah of Judah — 640–609 BC

Chapter 34

Josiah began to seek the LORD as a boy and in his twelfth year purged Judah of idols. During temple repairs the Book of the Law was found; Josiah tore his clothes, consulted the prophetess Huldah, and renewed the covenant before the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem one and thirty years.</i> | Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign. He reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem. |
| 2 | <i>And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the ways of David his father, and declined neither to the right hand, nor to the left.</i> | He did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, and walked in the ways of David his father. He did not turn aside to the right or to the left. |

- 3 *For in the eighth year of his reign, while he was yet young, he began to seek after the God of David his father: and in the twelfth year he began to purge Judah and Jerusalem from the high places, and the groves, and the carved images, and the molten images.* For in the eighth year of his reign, while he was yet a boy, he began to seek the God of David his father, and in the twelfth year he began to purge Judah and Jerusalem of the high places, the groves, and the carved and the molten images.
- 4 *And they brake down the altars of Baalim in his presence; and the images, that were on high above them, he cut down; and the groves, and the carved images, and the molten images, he brake in pieces, and made dust of them, and strowed it upon the graves of them that had sacrificed unto them.* They broke down the altars of Baalim in his presence. He cut down the images that were on high above them. He broke in pieces the groves and the carved images and the molten images, made dust of them, and scattered it over the graves of those who had sacrificed to them.
- 5 *And he burnt the bones of the priests upon their altars, and cleansed Judah and Jerusalem.* He also burned the bones of the priests on their altars and cleansed Judah and Jerusalem.
- 6 *And so did he in the cities of Manasseh, and Ephraim, and Simeon, even unto Naphtali, with their mattocks round about.* In the cities of Manasseh, Ephraim, and Simeon, and as far as Naphtali, in their ruins all around,
- 7 *And when he had broken down the altars and the groves, and had beaten the graven images into powder, and cut down all the idols throughout all the land of Israel, he returned to Jerusalem.* He broke down the altars and the groves and beat the graven images into powder and cut down all the idols throughout all the land of Israel. Then he returned to Jerusalem.

- 8 *Now in the eighteenth year of his reign, when he had purged the land, and the house, he sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, and Maaseiah the governor of the city, and Joah the son of Joahaz the recorder, to repair the house of the LORD his God.* Now in the eighteenth year of His reign, when He had purged the land and the house, He sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, and Maaseiah the governor of the city, and Joah the son of Joahaz, the recorder, to repair the house of the LORD His God.
- 9 *And when they came to Hilkiah the high priest, they delivered the money that was brought into the house of God, which the Levites that kept the doors had gathered of the hand of Manasseh and Ephraim, and of all the remnant of Israel, and of all Judah and Benjamin; and they returned to Jerusalem.* They came to Hilkiah the high priest and delivered the money that had been brought into the house of God, which the Levites, the gatekeepers, had collected from Manasseh and Ephraim and from all the remnant of Israel and from all Judah and Benjamin and from the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
- 10 *And they put it in the hand of the workmen that had the oversight of the house of the LORD, and they gave it to the workmen that wrought in the house of the LORD, to repair and amend the house:* They gave it to the workmen who had the oversight of the house of the LORD. And the workmen who were working in the house of the LORD gave it for repairing and restoring the house.
- 11 *Even to the artificers and builders gave they it, to buy hewn stone, and timber for couplings, and to floor the houses which the kings of Judah had destroyed.* They gave it to the carpenters and the builders to buy quarried stone, and timber for binders and beams for the buildings that the kings of Judah had let go to ruin.
- 12 *And the men did the work faithfully: and the overseers of them were Jahath and Obadiah, the Levites, of the sons of Merari; and Zechariah and Meshullam, of the sons of the Kohathites, to set it forward; and other of the Levites, all that could skill of instruments of musick.* The men did the work faithfully. Over them were set Jahath and Obadiah the Levites, of the sons of Merari, and Zechariah and Meshullam, of the sons of the Kohathites, to have oversight. The Levites, all who were skillful with instruments of music,

- 13 *Also they were over the bearers of burdens, and were overseers of all that wrought the work in any manner of service: and of the Levites there were scribes, and officers, and porters.* Were over the burden-bearers and directed all who did work in every kind of service. And some of the Levites were scribes and officials and gatekeepers.
- 14 *And when they brought out the money that was brought into the house of the LORD, Hilkiyah the priest found a book of the law of the LORD given by Moses.* While they were bringing out the money that had been brought into the house of the LORD, Hilkiyah the priest found the Book of the Law of the LORD given through Moses.
- 15 *And Hilkiyah answered and said to Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiyah delivered the book to Shaphan.* Then Hilkiyah answered and said to Shaphan the secretary, "I have found the Book of the Law in the house of the LORD." And Hilkiyah gave the book to Shaphan.
- 16 *And Shaphan carried the book to the king, and brought the king word back again, saying, All that was committed to thy servants, they do it.* Shaphan brought the book to the king, and further reported to the king, "All that was committed to your servants they are doing.
- 17 *And they have gathered together the money that was found in the house of the LORD, and have delivered it into the hand of the overseers, and to the hand of the workmen.* They have emptied out the money that was found in the house of the LORD and have given it into the hand of the overseers and the workmen."
- 18 *Then Shaphan the scribe told the king, saying, Hilkiyah the priest hath given me a book. And Shaphan read it before the king.* Then Shaphan the secretary told the king, "Hilkiyah the priest has given me a book." And Shaphan read from it before the king.
- 19 *And it came to pass, when the king had heard the words of the law, that he rent his clothes.* When the king heard the words of the Law, he tore his clothes.

- 20 *And the king commanded Hilkiah, and Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Abdon the son of Micah, and Shaphan the scribe, and Asaiah a servant of the king's, saying,* The king commanded Hilkiah, Ahikam the son of Shaphan, Abdon the son of Micah, Shaphan the secretary, and Asaiah the king's servant, saying,
- 21 *Go, enquire of the LORD for me, and for them that are left in Israel and in Judah, concerning the words of the book that is found: for great is the wrath of the LORD that is poured out upon us, because our fathers have not kept the word of the LORD, to do after all that is written in this book.* "Go, inquire of the LORD for me and for those who are left in Israel and in Judah, concerning the words of the book that has been found. For great is the wrath of the LORD that is poured out on us, because our fathers have not kept the word of the LORD, to do according to all that is written in this book."
- 22 *And Hilkiah, and they that the king had appointed, went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvath, the son of Hasrah, keeper of the wardrobe; (now she dwelt in Jerusalem in the college:) and they spake to her to that effect.* So Hilkiah and those whom the king had sent went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tokhath, son of Hasrah, keeper of the wardrobe — she lived in Jerusalem in the Second Quarter — and they spoke to her to that effect.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Huldah** (HUL-duh) — "weasel" — A prophetess in Jerusalem during the reign of King Josiah. When the Book of the Law was discovered in the temple, the king's officials consulted her rather than Jeremiah or Zephaniah. She confirmed that God's judgment would come upon Judah for its unfaithfulness, but that Josiah would be spared because of his tender heart.
- 23 *And she answered them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Tell ye the man that sent you to me,* She said to them, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: 'Tell the man who sent you to me,
- 24 *Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, even all the curses that are written in the book which they have read before the king of Judah:* Thus says the LORD, I will bring disaster upon this place and upon its inhabitants, all the curses that are written in the book that was read before the king of Judah.

- 25 *Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be poured out upon this place, and shall not be quenched.* Because they have forsaken me and have made offerings to other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands, therefore my wrath will be poured out on this place and will not be quenched.
- 26 *And as for the king of Judah, who sent you to enquire of the LORD, so shall ye say unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel concerning the words which thou hast heard;* But to the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of the LORD, thus shall You say to Him, Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: Regarding the words that You have heard,
- 27 *Because thine heart was tender, and thou didst humble thyself before God, when thou heardest his words against this place, and against the inhabitants thereof, and humbledst thyself before me, and didst rend thy clothes, and weep before me; I have even heard thee also, saith the LORD.* Because Your heart was penitent and You humbled Yourself before God when You heard His words against this place and its inhabitants, and You have humbled Yourself before me and have torn Your clothes and wept before me, I also have heard You, declares the LORD.
- 28 *Behold, I will gather thee to thy fathers, and thou shalt be gathered to thy grave in peace, neither shall thine eyes see all the evil that I will bring upon this place, and upon the inhabitants of the same. So they brought the king word again.* I will gather you to your fathers, and you shall be gathered to your grave in peace, and your eyes shall not see all the disaster that I will bring upon this place and its inhabitants.' " And they brought back word to the king.
- 29 *Then the king sent and gathered together all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem.* Then the king sent and gathered together all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem.

- 30 *And the king went up into the house of the LORD, and all the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and the priests, and the Levites, and all the people, great and small: and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant that was found in the house of the LORD.* The king went up to the house of the LORD, with all the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem and the priests and the Levites, all the people both great and small. And he read in their hearing all the words of the Book of the Covenant that had been found in the house of the LORD.
- 31 *And the king stood in his place, and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments, and his testimonies, and his statutes, with all his heart, and with all his soul, to perform the words of the covenant which are written in this book.* The king stood in his place and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD and to keep His commandments and His testimonies and His statutes, with all His heart and all His soul, to perform the words of the covenant that were written in this book.
- 32 *And he caused all that were present in Jerusalem and Benjamin to stand to it. And the inhabitants of Jerusalem did according to the covenant of God, the God of their fathers.* Then He made all who were present in Jerusalem and in Benjamin join in it. And the inhabitants of Jerusalem did according to the covenant of God, the God of their fathers.
- 33 *And Josiah took away all the abominations out of all the countries that pertained to the children of Israel, and made all that were present in Israel to serve, even to serve the LORD their God. And all his days they departed not from following the LORD, the God of their fathers.* Josiah took away all the abominations from all the territory that belonged to the people of Israel and made all who were present in Israel serve the LORD their God. All His days they did not turn away from following the LORD, the God of their fathers.

Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Cross-References:

v2 — 2 Chr 29:2; Josh 1:7

v3 — 2 Chr 33:22

v4 — Ex 32:20

v5 — 1 Kgs 13:2

v25 — Jer 7:20

v27 — 2 Chr 32:26; Ps 34:18; Ezek 9:4

v28 — Ps 37:37; Isa 39:8

Chapter 35

Josiah kept a Passover to the LORD such as had not been kept since the days of Samuel. Afterward Josiah went out against Pharaoh Necho of Egypt at Megiddo and was mortally wounded; all Judah mourned for him.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover Josiah kept a passover unto the LORD in Jerusalem: and they killed the passover on the fourteenth day of the first month.</i></p> | <p>Josiah kept a Passover to the LORD in Jerusalem. And they slaughtered the Passover lamb on the fourteenth day of the first month.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he set the priests in their charges, and encouraged them to the service of the house of the LORD,</i></p> | <p>He appointed the priests to their offices and encouraged them in the service of the house of the LORD.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And said unto the Levites that taught all Israel, which were holy unto the LORD, Put the holy ark in the house which Solomon the son of David king of Israel did build; it shall not be a burden upon your shoulders: serve now the LORD your God, and his people Israel,</i></p> | <p>He said to the Levites who taught all Israel and who were holy to the LORD, "Put the holy ark in the house that Solomon the son of David, king of Israel, built. You need not carry it on Your shoulders. Now serve the LORD Your God and His people Israel.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And prepare yourselves by the houses of your fathers, after your courses, according to the writing of David king of Israel, and according to the writing of Solomon his son.</i></p> | <p>Prepare yourselves according to your fathers' houses by your divisions, following the written directions of David king of Israel and the written directions of Solomon his son.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And stand in the holy place according to the divisions of the families of the fathers of your brethren the people, and after the division of the families of the Levites.</i></p> | <p>Stand in the holy place according to the groupings of the fathers' houses of your brothers the lay people, and according to the division of the Levites by fathers' house.</p> |

- 6 *So kill the passover, and sanctify yourselves, and prepare your brethren, that they may do according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.* Slaughter the Passover lamb and consecrate yourselves, and prepare for Your brothers, to do according to the word of the LORD by Moses."
- 7 *And Josiah gave to the people, of the flock, lambs and kids, all for the passover offerings, for all that were present, to the number of thirty thousand, and three thousand bullocks: these were of the king's substance.* Then Josiah contributed to the lay people, as Passover offerings for all who were present, lambs and young goats from the flock to the number of thirty thousand, and three thousand bulls; these were from the king's possessions.
- 8 *And his princes gave willingly unto the people, to the priests, and to the Levites: Hilkiah and Zechariah and Jehiel, rulers of the house of God, gave unto the priests for the passover offerings two thousand and six hundred small cattle, and three hundred oxen.* His officials contributed willingly to the people, to the priests, and to the Levites. Hilkiah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, the chief officers of the house of God, gave to the priests for the Passover offerings two thousand six hundred lambs and three hundred bulls.
- 9 *Conaniah also, and Shemaiah and Nethaneel, his brethren, and Hashabiah and Jeiel and Jozabad, chief of the Levites, gave unto the Levites for passover offerings five thousand small cattle, and five hundred oxen.* Conaniah also, and Shemaiah and Nethanel his brothers, and Hashabiah and Jeiel and Jozabad, the chiefs of the Levites, gave to the Levites for the Passover offerings five thousand lambs and five hundred bulls.
- 10 *So the service was prepared, and the priests stood in their place, and the Levites in their courses, according to the king's commandment.* When the service had been prepared for, the priests stood in their place, and the Levites in their divisions according to the king's command.
- 11 *And they killed the passover, and the priests sprinkled the blood from their hands, and the Levites played them.* They slaughtered the Passover lamb, and the priests threw the blood that they received from them while the Levites played the animals.

- 12 *And they removed the burnt offerings, that they might give according to the divisions of the families of the people, to offer unto the LORD, as it is written in the book of Moses. And so did they with the oxen.* They set aside the burnt offerings that they might distribute them according to the groupings of the fathers' houses of the lay people, to offer to the LORD, as it is written in the Book of Moses. And so they did with the bulls.
- 13 *And they roasted the passover with fire according to the ordinance: but the other holy offerings sod they in pots, and in caldrons, and in pans, and divided them speedily among all the people.* They roasted the Passover lamb with fire according to the rule. They boiled the holy offerings in pots, in cauldrons, and in pans, and carried them quickly to all the lay people.
- 14 *And afterward they made ready for themselves, and for the priests: because the priests the sons of Aaron were busied in offering of burnt offerings and the fat until night; therefore the Levites prepared for themselves, and for the priests the sons of Aaron.* Afterward they prepared for themselves and for the priests, because the priests, the sons of Aaron, were busy offering the burnt offerings and the fat parts until night; so the Levites prepared for themselves and for the priests, the sons of Aaron.
- 15 *And the singers the sons of Asaph were in their place, according to the commandment of David, and Asaph, and Heman, and Jeduthun the king's seer; and the porters waited at every gate; they might not depart from their service; for their brethren the Levites prepared for them.* The singers, the sons of Asaph, were in their place according to the command of David, and Asaph, and Heman, and Jeduthun the king's seer. The gatekeepers were at each gate. They did not need to depart from their service, for their brothers the Levites prepared for them.
- 16 *So all the service of the LORD was prepared the same day, to keep the passover, and to offer burnt offerings upon the altar of the LORD, according to the commandment of king Josiah.* So all the service of the LORD was prepared that day, to keep the Passover and to offer burnt offerings on the altar of the LORD, according to the command of King Josiah.

- 17 *And the children of Israel that were present kept the passover at that time, and the feast of unleavened bread seven days.* The people of Israel who were present kept the Passover at that time, and the Feast of Unleavened Bread seven days.
- 18 *And there was no passover like to that kept in Israel from the days of Samuel the prophet; neither did all the kings of Israel keep such a passover as Josiah kept, and the priests, and the Levites, and all Judah and Israel that were present, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.* No Passover like it had been kept in Israel since the days of Samuel the prophet. None of the kings of Israel had kept such a Passover as was kept by Josiah, and the priests and the Levites. All Judah and Israel who were present, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
- 19 *In the eighteenth year of the reign of Josiah was this passover kept.* In the eighteenth year of the reign of Josiah this Passover was kept.
- 20 *After all this, when Josiah had prepared the temple, Necho king of Egypt came up to fight against Carchemish by Euphrates: and Josiah went out against him.* After all this, when Josiah had prepared the temple, Neco king of Egypt went up to fight at Carchemish on the Euphrates, and Josiah went out to meet him.
- 21 *But he sent ambassadors to him, saying, What have I to do with thee, thou king of Judah? I come not against thee this day, but against the house wherewith I have war: for God commanded me to make haste: forbear thee from meddling with God, who is with me, that he destroy thee not.* But Neco sent envoys to him, saying, "What have we to do with each other, king of Judah? I am not coming against you this day, but against the house with which I am at war. And God has commanded me to hurry. Cease opposing God, Who is with me, lest He destroy you."
- 22 *Nevertheless Josiah would not turn his face from him, but disguised himself, that he might fight with him, and hearkened not unto the words of Necho from the mouth of God, and came to fight in the valley of Megiddo.* Nevertheless, Josiah did not turn away from him, but disguised himself in order to fight with him. He did not listen to the words of Neco from the mouth of God, but came to fight in the plain of Megiddo.

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| <p>23 <i>And the archers shot at king Josiah; and the king said to his servants, Have me away; for I am sore wounded.</i></p> | <p>The archers shot King Josiah. And the king said to his servants, "Take me away, for I am badly wounded."</p> |
| <p>24 <i>His servants therefore took him out of that chariot, and put him in the second chariot that he had; and they brought him to Jerusalem, and he died, and was buried in one of the sepulchres of his fathers. And all Judah and Jerusalem mourned for Josiah.</i></p> | <p>So his servants took him out of the chariot and carried him in his second chariot and brought him to Jerusalem. And he died and was buried in the tombs of his fathers. All Judah and Jerusalem mourned for Josiah.</p> |
| <p>25 <i>And Jeremiah lamented for Josiah: and all the singing men and the singing women spake of Josiah in their lamentations to this day, and made them an ordinance in Israel: and, behold, they are written in the lamentations.</i></p> | <p>Jeremiah also uttered a lament for Josiah. All the singing men and singing women have spoken of Josiah in their laments to this day. They made these a rule in Israel; they are written in the Laments.</p> |
| <p>26 <i>Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and his goodness, according to that which was written in the law of the LORD,</i></p> | <p>Now the rest of the acts of Josiah. His good deeds according to what is written in the Law of the LORD,</p> |
| <p>27 <i>And his deeds, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.</i></p> | <p>His acts, from first to last, they are written in the Book of the Kings of Israel and Judah.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Megiddo (*meh-GID-oh*) — A strategic city at the pass through the Carmel range — site of many decisive battles; in Revelation, Armageddon (Har-Megiddo) is the great final battlefield.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 12:6
- v3 — 1 Chr 23:26
- v4 — 2 Chr 8:14
- v6 — 2 Chr 29:5
- v11 — 2 Chr 29:34
- v13 — Ex 12:8-9
- v22 — Judg 5:19

<i>Jehoahaz of Judah — 609 BC</i>
<i>Jehoiakim of Judah — 609–598 BC</i>
<i>Jehoiachin of Judah — 598–597 BC</i>
<i>Zedekiah of Judah — 597–586 BC (last king of Judah)</i>

Chapter 36

Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, and Zedekiah each reigned over Judah in succession, doing evil and ignoring the prophets. Nebuchadnezzar destroyed the temple and carried Judah into exile in Babylon; the land rested seventy years until Cyrus of Persia decreed the return.

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| 1 | <i>Then the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and made him king in his father's stead in Jerusalem.</i> | The people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah and made him king in his father's place in Jerusalem. |
| 2 | <i>Jehoahaz was twenty and three years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem.</i> | Jehoahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign. He reigned three months in Jerusalem. |
| 3 | <i>Then the king of Egypt put him down at Jerusalem, and condemned the land in an hundred talents of silver and a talent of gold.</i> | Then the king of Egypt deposed him at Jerusalem and laid on the land a tribute of one hundred talents of silver and one talent of gold. |
| 4 | <i>And the king of Egypt made Eliakim his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem, and turned his name to Jehoiakim. And Neco took Jehoahaz his brother, and carried him to Egypt.</i> | The king of Egypt made Eliakim his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem and changed his name to Jehoiakim. But Neco took Jehoahaz his brother and carried him to Egypt. |

- 5 *Jehoiakim was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: and he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD his God.* Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD His God.
- 6 *Against him came up Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and bound him in fetters, to carry him to Babylon.* Against him came up Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and bound him in chains to take him to Babylon.
- 7 *Nebuchadnezzar also carried of the vessels of the house of the LORD to Babylon, and put them in his temple at Babylon.* Nebuchadnezzar also carried part of the vessels of the house of the LORD to Babylon and put them in His palace at Babylon.
- 8 *Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and his abominations which he did, and that which was found in him, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah: and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his stead.* Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and the abominations that he did, and what was found against Him, they are written in the Book of the Kings of Israel and Judah. And Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place.
- 9 *Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem: and he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD.* Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign. He reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem. He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD.
- 10 *And when the year was expired, king Nebuchadnezzar sent, and brought him to Babylon, with the goodly vessels of the house of the LORD, and made Zedekiah his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem.* In the spring of the year King Nebuchadnezzar sent and brought him to Babylon, with the precious vessels of the house of the LORD, and made His brother Zedekiah king over Judah and Jerusalem.
- 11 *Zedekiah was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned eleven years in Jerusalem.* Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem.

- 12 *And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD his God, and humbled not himself before Jeremiah the prophet speaking from the mouth of the LORD.* He did what was evil in the sight of the LORD His God. He did not humble Himself before Jeremiah the prophet, who spoke from the mouth of the LORD.
- 13 *And he also rebelled against king Nebuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by God: but he stiffened his neck, and hardened his heart from turning unto the LORD God of Israel.* He also rebelled against King Nebuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by God. He stiffened His neck and hardened His heart against turning to the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 14 *Moreover all the chief of the priests, and the people, transgressed very much after all the abominations of the heathen; and polluted the house of the LORD which he had hallowed in Jerusalem.* All the officers of the priests and the people likewise were greatly unfaithful, following all the abominations of the nations. And they polluted the house of the LORD that He had made holy in Jerusalem.
- 15 *And the LORD God of their fathers sent to them by his messengers, rising up betimes, and sending; because he had compassion on his people, and on his dwelling place:* The LORD, the God of their fathers, sent persistently to them by His messengers, because He had compassion on His people and on His dwelling place.
- 16 *But they mocked the messengers of God, and despised his words, and misused his prophets, until the wrath of the LORD arose against his people, till there was no remedy.* But they kept mocking the messengers of God, despising His words and scoffing at His prophets, until the wrath of the LORD rose against His people, until there was no remedy.
- 17 *Therefore he brought upon them the king of the Chaldees, who slew their young men with the sword in the house of their sanctuary, and had no compassion upon young man or maiden, old man, or him that stooped for age: he gave them all into his hand.* Therefore he brought up against them the king of the Chaldeans, who killed their young men with the sword in the house of their sanctuary and had no compassion on young man or virgin, old man or aged. He gave them all into his hand.

- 18 *And all the vessels of the house of God, great and small, and the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king, and of his princes; all these he brought to Babylon.* All the vessels of the house of God, great and small, and the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king and of his princes, all these he brought to Babylon.
- 19 *And they burnt the house of God, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem, and burnt all the palaces thereof with fire, and destroyed all the goodly vessels thereof.* They burned the house of God and broke down the wall of Jerusalem and burned all its palaces with fire and destroyed all its precious vessels.
- 20 *And them that had escaped from the sword carried he away to Babylon; where they were servants to him and his sons until the reign of the kingdom of Persia:* He took into exile in Babylon those who had escaped from the sword. They became servants to Him and to His sons until the establishment of the kingdom of Persia,
- 21 *To fulfil the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah, until the land had enjoyed her sabbaths: for as long as she lay desolate she kept sabbath, to fulfil threescore and ten years.* To fulfill the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah, until the land had enjoyed its Sabbaths. All the days that it lay desolate it kept Sabbath, to fulfill seventy years.
- 22 *Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD spoken by the mouth of Jeremiah might be accomplished, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,* Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, so that he made a proclamation throughout all His kingdom and also put it in writing:

- 23 *Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, All the kingdoms of the earth hath the LORD God of heaven given me; and he hath charged me to build him an house in Jerusalem, which is in Judah. Who is there among you of all his people? The LORD his God be with him, and let him go up.* "Thus says Cyrus king of Persia, 'The LORD, the God of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth. He has charged me to build Him a house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah. Whoever is among you of all his people, may the LORD His God be with Him. Let Him go up.' "

Words in this chapter:

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v7 — 2 Kgs 24:13

v10 — Jer 37:1

v15 — Jer 7:13; Jer 35:15

v16 — Jer 5:12-13; 2 Chr 30:10; Luke 22:63-64

v18 — 2 Chr 36:7; 2 Chr 36:10

v20 — Jer 27:7

v21 — Jer 29:10; Lev 26:34-35; Jer 25:11-12; Zech 1:12; Dan 9:2

v22 — Jer 25:12; Ezra 1:1-3; Jer 29:10; 2 Chr 36:21; Isa 44:28-45:5

THE PERSIAN PERIOD BEGINS — 538 BC

Babylon has fallen to Cyrus the Persian without a single battle — the city taken in a night while Belshazzar feasted. In his first year as king of the new empire, Cyrus issues a decree allowing the Jews to return to Jerusalem and rebuild the temple — exactly as the prophet Isaiah had foretold, naming Cyrus by name two centuries before he was born (Isaiah 44:28; 45:1). The seventy years of exile, measured out by Jeremiah, are ending. Persia will reign over the known world for the next two hundred years, and the Old Testament closes inside its borders.

Ezra

Author: *Ezra the priest, traditionally — Jewish and Christian tradition consistently names him as the author of both Ezra and Nehemiah, which were originally a single scroll.*

Date written: *c. 457–440 BC, compiled from official Persian records, letters, and Ezra's personal memoirs.*

Written to: *The Jewish community in Jerusalem and the returned exiles, to establish the legitimacy of the restoration and its leadership.*

Setting: *The Babylonian exile is over. Cyrus the Great has issued his decree allowing the Jews to return. Over roughly eighty years, two waves of exiles come back to Jerusalem — the first under Zerubbabel, the second under Ezra himself.*

Where this sits historically: *c. 538–458 BC, the early Persian period; Cyrus the Great's decree (538 BC) opens the book, and Ezra's own arrival under Artaxerxes I (458 BC) closes it.*

Contemporaries: *The prophets Haggai and Zechariah at the temple rebuild (520 BC); Daniel still alive in early years; Nehemiah arrives in Jerusalem soon after Ezra; Persia ruled by Cyrus, Darius I, Xerxes, and Artaxerxes I across the span.*

Big themes:

- Restoration — God keeps His promises; the seventy years of exile end exactly as Jeremiah prophesied
- The temple — rebuilding the house of God is the central act of the return and faces fierce opposition
- The word of God — Ezra's ministry is defined by reading, studying, and teaching the law
- Separation — the returned community must not intermarry with the surrounding peoples; the purity of the covenant line matters
- Persian sovereignty — God works through pagan kings (Cyrus, Darius, Artaxerxes) to accomplish His purposes

Key passages: *Ezra 1:1–3; 3:11; 6:14; 7:10; 9:6*

How it fits: *Ezra is the direct sequel to 2 Chronicles — the last verse of Chronicles and the first verses of Ezra overlap. The book bridges the gap between captivity and the restoration community. Nehemiah continues the story, and together the two books complete the OT historical narrative.*

Chapter 1

In the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, the LORD stirred his spirit to decree that the Jews could return to Jerusalem and rebuild the temple. Cyrus also returned the gold and silver vessels Nebuchadnezzar had taken from the house of God.

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| <p>1 <i>Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, so that he made a proclamation throughout all His kingdom and also put it in writing:</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cyrus** (SY-rus) — "sun" or "throne" — *Cyrus the Great, founder of the Persian Empire, who conquered Babylon in 539 BC. God called him by name through Isaiah (44:28, 45:1) over a century before his birth. He issued the decree allowing the Jewish exiles to return to Jerusalem and rebuild the temple, fulfilling Jeremiah's prophecy.*

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| <p>2 <i>Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, The LORD God of heaven hath given me all the kingdoms of the earth; and he hath charged me to build him an house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.</i></p> | <p>"Thus says Cyrus king of Persia: The LORD, the God of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth. He has charged me to build Him a house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Who is there among you of all his people? his God be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and build the house of the LORD God of Israel, (he is the God,) which is in Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Whoever is among you of all his people, may his God be with Him, and let Him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and rebuild the house of the LORD, the God of Israel — He is the God Who is in Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And whosoever remaineth in any place where he sojourneth, let the men of his place help him with silver, and with gold, and with goods, and with beasts, beside the freewill offering for the house of God that is in Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Let each survivor, in whatever place He sojourns, be assisted by the men of His place with silver and gold, with goods and with beasts, besides freewill offerings for the house of God that is in Jerusalem."</p> |

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| <p>5 <i>Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests, and the Levites, with all them whose spirit God had raised, to go up to build the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And all they that were about them strengthened their hands with vessels of silver, with gold, with goods, and with beasts, and with precious things, beside all that was willingly offered.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Also Cyrus the king brought forth the vessels of the house of the LORD, which Nebuchadnezzar had brought forth out of Jerusalem, and had put them in the house of his gods;</i></p> <p>8 <i>Even those did Cyrus king of Persia bring forth by the hand of Mithredath the treasurer, and numbered them unto Sheshbazzar, the prince of Judah.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And this is the number of them: thirty chargers of gold, a thousand chargers of silver, nine and twenty knives,</i></p> <p>10 <i>Thirty basons of gold, silver basons of a second sort four hundred and ten, and other vessels a thousand.</i></p> <p>11 <i>All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand and four hundred. All these did Sheshbazzar bring up with them of the captivity that were brought up from Babylon unto Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Then rose up the heads of the fathers' houses of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests and the Levites, everyone whose spirit God had stirred to go up to rebuild the house of the LORD that is in Jerusalem.</p> <p>All who were around them aided them with vessels of silver, with gold, with goods, with beasts, and with costly wares, besides all that was freely offered.</p> <p>Cyrus the king also brought out the vessels of the house of the LORD that Nebuchadnezzar had carried away from Jerusalem and placed in the house of His gods.</p> <p>Cyrus king of Persia brought these out in the charge of Mithredath the treasurer, who counted them out to Sheshbazzar the prince of Judah.</p> <p>This was the number of them: thirty chargers of gold, one thousand chargers of silver, twenty-nine knives,</p> <p>Thirty bowls of gold, four hundred ten bowls of silver of a second kind, and one thousand other vessels;</p> <p>All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand four hundred. All these Sheshbazzar brought up, when the exiles were brought up from Babylon to Jerusalem.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 29:10; 2 Chr 36:22-23; Jer 25:12-14; Ezra 6:22; Ezra 7:27

v2 — Isa 45:12-13

v3 — Dan 6:26; Jer 10:10

v5 — Ezra 1:1

v7 — 2 Chr 36:7; Ezra 5:14; Ezra 6:5; 2 Kgs 24:13

v8 — Ezra 5:14

Chapter 2

The chapter lists by family the exiles who returned to Jerusalem and Judah with Zerubbabel, totaling 42,360 besides servants. The leaders gave freewill offerings of gold and silver for the rebuilding of the temple.

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| <p>¹ <i>Now these are the children of the province that went up out of the captivity, of those which had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away unto Babylon, and came again unto Jerusalem and Judah, every one unto his city;</i></p> | <p>Now these were the people of the province who came up out of the captivity of those exiles whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried captive to Babylon. They returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his own town.</p> |
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| 2 <i>Which came with Zerubbabel: Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel:</i> | They came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, and Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel: |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zerubbabel** (zeh-RUB-uh-bel) — "seed of Babylon" or "born in Babylon" — A descendant of King David who led the first wave of Jewish exiles back from Babylon to Jerusalem. He served as governor of Judah and oversaw the rebuilding of the temple's foundation. He appears in the genealogy of Christ (Matt 1:12).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jeshua** (JESH-oo-uh) — "the LORD is salvation" — The high priest who returned from Babylon with Zerubbabel and led the spiritual restoration of Israel. He and Zerubbabel together rebuilt the altar and laid the temple's foundation. Also called Joshua the son of Jozadak; his name is the Hebrew form of "Jesus."

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| 3 <i>The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.</i> | The sons of Parosh, two thousand one hundred seventy-two. |
| 4 <i>The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.</i> | The sons of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy-two. |
| 5 <i>The children of Arah, seven hundred seventy and five.</i> | The sons of Arah, seven hundred seventy-five. |
| 6 <i>The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and twelve.</i> | The sons of Pahath-moab, namely the sons of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred twelve. |
| 7 <i>The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.</i> | The sons of Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. |
| 8 <i>The children of Zattu, nine hundred forty and five.</i> | The sons of Zattu, nine hundred forty-five. |
| 9 <i>The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.</i> | The sons of Zaccai, seven hundred sixty. |
| 10 <i>The children of Bani, six hundred forty and two.</i> | The sons of Bani, six hundred forty-two. |
| 11 <i>The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and three.</i> | The sons of Bebai, six hundred twenty-three. |
| 12 <i>The children of Azgad, a thousand two hundred twenty and two.</i> | The sons of Azgad, one thousand two hundred twenty-two. |

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| 13 <i>The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty and six.</i> | The sons of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-six. |
| 14 <i>The children of Bigvai, two thousand fifty and six.</i> | The sons of Bigvai, two thousand fifty-six. |
| 15 <i>The children of Adin, four hundred fifty and four.</i> | The sons of Adin, four hundred fifty-four. |
| 16 <i>The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.</i> | The sons of Ater, namely of Hezekiah, ninety-eight. |
| 17 <i>The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and three.</i> | The sons of Bezai, three hundred twenty-three. |
| 18 <i>The children of Jorah, an hundred and twelve.</i> | The sons of Jorah, one hundred twelve. |
| 19 <i>The children of Hashum, two hundred twenty and three.</i> | The sons of Hashum, two hundred twenty-three. |
| 20 <i>The children of Gibbar, ninety and five.</i> | The sons of Gibbar, ninety-five. |
| 21 <i>The children of Bethlehem, an hundred twenty and three.</i> | The men of Bethlehem, one hundred twenty-three. |
| 22 <i>The men of Netophah, fifty and six.</i> | The men of Netophah, fifty-six. |
| 23 <i>The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.</i> | The men of Anathoth, one hundred twenty-eight. |
| 24 <i>The children of Azmaveth, forty and two.</i> | The men of Azmaveth, forty-two. |
| 25 <i>The children of Kirjatharim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred and forty and three.</i> | The men of Kiriath-jearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred forty-three. |
| 26 <i>The children of Ramah and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one.</i> | The men of Ramah and Geba, six hundred twenty-one. |
| 27 <i>The men of Michmas, an hundred twenty and two.</i> | The men of Michmas, one hundred twenty-two. |
| 28 <i>The men of Bethel and Ai, two hundred twenty and three.</i> | The men of Bethel and Ai, two hundred twenty-three. |

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| 29 | <i>The children of Nebo, fifty and two.</i> | The sons of Nebo, fifty-two. |
| 30 | <i>The children of Magbish, an hundred fifty and six.</i> | The sons of Magbish, one hundred fifty-six. |
| 31 | <i>The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.</i> | The sons of the other Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. |
| 32 | <i>The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.</i> | The sons of Harim, three hundred twenty. |
| 33 | <i>The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and five.</i> | The men of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty-five. |
| 34 | <i>The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.</i> | The men of Jericho, three hundred forty-five. |
| 35 | <i>The children of Senaah, three thousand and six hundred and thirty.</i> | The sons of Senaah, three thousand six hundred thirty. |
| 36 | <i>The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.</i> | The priests: the sons of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy-three. |
| 37 | <i>The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.</i> | The sons of Immer, one thousand fifty-two. |
| 38 | <i>The children of Pashhur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.</i> | The sons of Pashhur, one thousand two hundred forty-seven. |
| 39 | <i>The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.</i> | The sons of Harim, one thousand seventeen. |
| 40 | <i>The Levites: the children of Jeshua and Kadmiel, of the children of Hodaviah, seventy and four.</i> | The Levites: the sons of Jeshua and Kadmiel, of the sons of Hodaviah, seventy-four. |
| 41 | <i>The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred twenty and eight.</i> | The singers: the sons of Asaph, one hundred twenty-eight. |
| 42 | <i>The children of the porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, in all an hundred thirty and nine.</i> | The sons of the gatekeepers: the sons of Shallum, the sons of Ater, the sons of Talmon, the sons of Akkub, the sons of Hatita, and the sons of Shobai, in all one hundred thirty-nine. |

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| 43 | <i>The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the children of Tabbaoth,</i> | The temple servants: the sons of Ziha, the sons of Hasupha, the sons of Tabbaoth, |
| 44 | <i>The children of Keros, the children of Siaha, the children of Padon,</i> | The sons of Keros, the sons of Siaha, the sons of Padon, |
| 45 | <i>The children of Lebanah, the children of Hagabah, the children of Akkub,</i> | The sons of Lebanah, the sons of Hagabah, the sons of Akkub, |
| 46 | <i>The children of Hagab, the children of Shalmal, the children of Hanan,</i> | The sons of Hagab, the sons of Shalmal, the sons of Hanan, |
| 47 | <i>The children of Giddel, the children of Gahar, the children of Reaiah,</i> | The sons of Giddel, the sons of Gahar, the sons of Reaiah, |
| 48 | <i>The children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda, the children of Gazzam,</i> | The sons of Rezin, the sons of Nekoda, the sons of Gazzam, |
| 49 | <i>The children of Uzza, the children of Paseah, the children of Besai,</i> | The sons of Uzza, the sons of Paseah, the sons of Besai, |
| 50 | <i>The children of Asnah, the children of Mehunim, the children of Nephusim,</i> | The sons of Asnah, the sons of Meunim, the sons of Nephisim, |
| 51 | <i>The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,</i> | The sons of Bakbuk, the sons of Hakupha, the sons of Harhur, |
| 52 | <i>The children of Bazluth, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha,</i> | The sons of Bazluth, the sons of Mehida, the sons of Harsha, |
| 53 | <i>The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Thamah,</i> | The sons of Barkos, the sons of Sisera, the sons of Temah, |
| 54 | <i>The children of Neziah, the children of Hatipha.</i> | The sons of Neziah, and the sons of Hatipha. |
| 55 | <i>The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Peruda,</i> | The sons of Solomon's servants: the sons of Sotai, the sons of Sophereth, the sons of Peruda, |
| 56 | <i>The children of Jaalah, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,</i> | The sons of Jaalah, the sons of Darkon, the sons of Giddel, |

- 57 *The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Ami.* The sons of Shephatiah, the sons of Hattil, the sons of Pochereth-hazzebaim, and the sons of Ami.
- 58 *All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.* All the temple servants and the sons of Solomon's servants were three hundred ninety-two.
- 59 *And these were they which went up from Telmelah, Telharsa, Cherub, Addan, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, and their seed, whether they were of Israel:* The following were those who came up from Tel-melah, Tel-harsha, Cherub, Addan, and Immer, though they could not prove their fathers' houses or their descent, whether they belonged to Israel:
- 60 *The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty and two.* The sons of Delaiah, the sons of Tobiah, and the sons of Nekoda, six hundred fifty-two.
- 61 *And of the children of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai; which took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name:* Also, of the sons of the priests: the sons of Hobaiah, the sons of Hakkoz, and the sons of Barzillai — who had taken a wife from the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite and was called by their name.
- 62 *These sought their register among those that were reckoned by genealogy, but they were not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.* These searched for their entries in the genealogical records. But they were not found there, and so they were excluded from the priesthood as unclean.
- 63 *And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with Urim and with Thummim.* The governor told them that they were not to partake of the most holy food until there should be a priest to consult Urim and Thummim.
- 64 *The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,* The whole assembly together was forty-two thousand three hundred sixty,

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| <p>65 <i>Beside their servants and their maids, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and there were among them two hundred singing men and singing women.</i></p> <p>66 <i>Their horses were seven hundred thirty and six; their mules, two hundred forty and five;</i></p> <p>67 <i>Their camels, four hundred thirty and five; their asses, six thousand seven hundred and twenty.</i></p> <p>68 <i>And some of the chief of the fathers, when they came to the house of the LORD which is at Jerusalem, offered freely for the house of God to set it up in his place:</i></p> <p>69 <i>They gave after their ability unto the treasure of the work threescore and one thousand drams of gold, and five thousand pound of silver, and one hundred priests' garments.</i></p> <p>70 <i>So the priests, and the Levites, and some of the people, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, dwelt in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.</i></p> | <p>Besides their male and female servants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven. They had two hundred male and female singers.</p> <p>Their horses were seven hundred thirty-six, their mules were two hundred forty-five,</p> <p>Their camels were four hundred thirty-five. Their donkeys were six thousand seven hundred twenty.</p> <p>Some of the heads of fathers' houses, when they came to the house of the LORD that is in Jerusalem, made freewill offerings for the house of God, to erect it on its site.</p> <p>According to their ability they gave to the treasury of the work sixty-one thousand darics of gold, five thousand minas of silver, and one hundred priests' garments.</p> <p>The priests, the Levites. Some of the people lived in Jerusalem and its vicinity, and the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants lived in their towns. All Israel in their towns.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Thummim (*THUM-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate alongside the Urim — together they were God's tool for giving yes/no answers to Israel's leaders.

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his

name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Nehemiah (*nee-heh-MY-ah*) — A cupbearer to the Persian king who returned to rebuild Jerusalem's walls — a man of prayer and practical leadership; his name means 'the LORD comforts.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Tirshatha (*ter-SHAY-thah*) — The Persian title given to Nehemiah (and to Zerubbabel in Ezra 2:63) — a title meaning 'governor' or 'his excellency'; used in the books of Ezra and Nehemiah.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Kgs 25:11; 2 Kgs 24:14-16

v38 — 1 Chr 9:12

v43 — 1 Chr 9:2

v58 — 1 Chr 9:2

v61 — 2 Sam 17:27

v68 — 2 Cor 9:7

Chapter 3

The returned exiles built the altar and offered burnt offerings in the seventh month, then laid the foundation of the temple in the second year. The old men who remembered Solomon's temple wept, while the younger generation shouted for joy.

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| <p>1 <i>And when the seventh month was come, and the children of Israel were in the cities, the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>When the seventh month came, and the people of Israel were in the towns, the people gathered as one man to Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then stood up Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren the priests, and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and his brethren, and builded the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings thereon, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God.</i></p> | <p>Then Jeshua the son of Jozadak, with his fellow priests, and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel with his kinsmen, arose and built the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings on it, as it is written in the Law of Moses the man of God.</p> |

- 3 *And they set the altar upon his bases; for fear was upon them because of the people of those countries: and they offered burnt offerings thereon unto the LORD, even burnt offerings morning and evening.* They set the altar in its place, for fear was on them because of the peoples of the lands. They offered burnt offerings on it to the LORD, burnt offerings morning and evening.
- 4 *They kept also the feast of tabernacles, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number, according to the custom, as the duty of every day required;* They kept the Feast of Booths, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number according to the rule, as each day required,
- 5 *And afterward offered the continual burnt offering, both of the new moons, and of all the set feasts of the LORD that were consecrated, and of every one that willingly offered a freewill offering unto the LORD.* After that the regular burnt offerings, the offerings at the new moon and at all the appointed feasts of the LORD, and the offerings of everyone who made a freewill offering to the LORD.
- 6 *From the first day of the seventh month began they to offer burnt offerings unto the LORD. But the foundation of the temple of the LORD was not yet laid.* From the first day of the seventh month they began to offer burnt offerings to the LORD. But the foundation of the temple of the LORD was not yet laid.
- 7 *They gave money also unto the masons, and to the carpenters; and meat, and drink, and oil, unto them of Zidon, and to them of Tyre, to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea of Joppa, according to the grant that they had of Cyrus king of Persia.* So they gave money to the masons and the carpenters, and food, drink, and oil to the Sidonians and the Tyrians to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea, to Joppa, according to the grant that they had from Cyrus king of Persia.

- 8 *Now in the second year of their coming unto the house of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, began Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and the remnant of their brethren the priests and the Levites, and all they that were come out of the captivity unto Jerusalem; and appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to set forward the work of the house of the LORD.*
- 9 *Then stood Jeshua with his sons and his brethren, Kadmiel and his sons, the sons of Judah, together, to set forward the workmen in the house of God: the sons of Henadad, with their sons and their brethren the Levites.*
- 10 *And when the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the LORD, they set the priests in their apparel with trumpets, and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise the LORD, after the ordinance of David king of Israel.*
- 11 *And they sang together by course in praising and giving thanks unto the LORD; because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever toward Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.*
- Now in the second year after their coming to the house of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and Jeshua the son of Jozadak made a beginning, together with the rest of their brothers, the priests and the Levites and all who had come to Jerusalem from the captivity. They appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to supervise the work of the house of the LORD.
- Jeshua with His sons and His brothers, and Kadmiel and His sons, the sons of Judah, together supervised the workmen in the house of God, along with the sons of Henadad and the Levites, their sons and brothers.
- When the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the LORD, the priests in their vestments came forward with trumpets, and the Levites, the sons of Asaph, with cymbals, to praise the LORD, according to the directions of David king of Israel.
- They sang responsively, praising and giving thanks to the LORD, "For He is good, for His mercy endures forever toward Israel." And all the people shouted with a great shout when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.

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| <p>12 <i>But many of the priests and Levites and chief of the fathers, who were ancient men, that had seen the first house, when the foundation of this house was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice; and many shouted aloud for joy:</i></p> <p>13 <i>So that the people could not discern the noise of the shout of joy from the noise of the weeping of the people: for the people shouted with a loud shout, and the noise was heard afar off.</i></p> | <p>But many of the priests and Levites and heads of fathers' houses, old men who had seen the first house, wept with a loud voice when they saw the foundation of this house being laid, though many shouted aloud for joy,</p> <p>So that the people could not distinguish the sound of the joyful shout from the sound of the people's weeping, for the people shouted with a great shout, and the sound was heard far away.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Feast of Tabernacles — Also called the Feast of Booths — a seven-day harvest festival where Israel lived in temporary shelters, remembering the wilderness wandering.

Zerubbabel (*zeh-RUB-ah-bel*) — The governor who led the first return of exiles from Babylon — laid the foundation of the second temple; his name means 'born in Babylon' or 'seed of Babylon.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Acts 4:32

v2 — Luke 3:27; Hag 1:1; 1 Chr 3:17; Ezra 2:2

v4 — Neh 8:14-17; Num 29:12-38; Ex 23:16

v11 — Ps 106:1; 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 107:1; Ps 103:17; Ps 135:3

v12 — Hag 2:3

Chapter 4

The adversaries of Judah offered to help build the temple but were refused; they then hired counselors to frustrate the work and wrote accusations to the Persian kings. The building was halted until the second year of Darius.

- 1 *Now when the adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the children of the captivity builded the temple unto the LORD God of Israel;* Now when the adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the returned exiles were building a temple to the LORD, the God of Israel,
- 2 *Then they came to Zerubbabel, and to the chief of the fathers, and said unto them, Let us build with you: for we seek your God, as ye do; and we do sacrifice unto him since the days of Esarhaddon king of Assur, which brought us up hither.* They approached Zerubbabel and the heads of fathers' houses and said to them, "Let us build with you, for we worship your God as you do. We have been sacrificing to Him ever since the days of Esarhaddon king of Assyria who brought us here."
- 3 *But Zerubbabel, and Jeshua, and the rest of the chief of the fathers of Israel, said unto them, Ye have nothing to do with us to build an house unto our God; but we ourselves together will build unto the LORD God of Israel, as king Cyrus the king of Persia hath commanded us.* But Zerubbabel, Jeshua, and the rest of the heads of fathers' houses in Israel said to them, "You have nothing to do with us in building a house to our God; but we alone will build to the LORD, the God of Israel, as King Cyrus the king of Persia has commanded us."
- 4 *Then the people of the land weakened the hands of the people of Judah, and troubled them in building,* Then the people of the land discouraged the people of Judah and made them afraid to build
- 5 *And hired counsellors against them, to frustrate their purpose, all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of Persia.* They hired counsellors against them to frustrate their purpose, all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of Persia.
- 6 *And in the reign of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reign, wrote they unto him an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem.* In the reign of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reign, they wrote an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem.

- 7 *And in the days of Artaxerxes wrote Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of their companions, unto Artaxerxes king of Persia; and the writing of the letter was written in the Syrian tongue, and interpreted in the Syrian tongue.* In the days of Artaxerxes, Bishlam and Mithredath and Tabeel and the rest of their associates wrote to Artaxerxes king of Persia. The letter was written in Aramaic and translated.
- 8 *Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king in this sort:* Rehum the commander and Shimshai the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king as follows:
- 9 *Then wrote Rehum the chancellor, and Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of their companions; the Dinaites, the Apharsathchites, the Tarpelites, the Apharsites, the Archevites, the Babylonians, the Susanchites, the Dehavites, and the Elamites,* Rehum the commander, Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of their associates — the judges, the governors, the officials, the Persians, the men of Erech, the Babylonians, the men of Susa, that is, the Elamites,
- 10 *And the rest of the nations whom the great and noble Asnapper brought over, and set in the cities of Samaria, and the rest that are on this side the river, and at such a time.* The rest of the nations whom the great and noble Osnappar deported and settled in the cities of Samaria and in the rest of the province Beyond the River —
- 11 *This is the copy of the letter that they sent unto him, even unto Artaxerxes the king; Thy servants the men on this side the river, and at such a time.* This is a copy of the letter that they sent to him, to Artaxerxes the king: "Your servants the men on this side the river, and at such a time.
- 12 *Be it known unto the king, that the Jews which came up from thee to us are come unto Jerusalem, building the rebellious and the bad city, and have set up the walls thereof, and joined the foundations.* Be it known to the king that the Jews who came up from you to us have gone to Jerusalem. They are rebuilding that rebellious and wicked city. They are finishing the walls and repairing the foundations.

- 13 *Be it known now unto the king, that, if this city be builded, and the walls set up again, then will they not pay toll, tribute, and custom, and so thou shalt endamage the revenue of the kings.* Now be it known to the king that if this city is rebuilt and the walls finished, they will not pay tribute, custom, or toll, and the royal revenue will be harmed.
- 14 *Now because we have maintenance from the king's palace, and it was not meet for us to see the king's dishonour, therefore have we sent and certified the king;* Now because we eat the salt of the palace and it is not fitting for us to witness the king's dishonor, therefore we send and inform the king,
- 15 *That search may be made in the book of the records of thy fathers: so shalt thou find in the book of the records, and know that this city is a rebellious city, and hurtful unto kings and provinces, and that they have moved sedition within the same of old time: for which cause was this city destroyed.* In order that search may be made in the book of the records of your fathers. So shall you find in the book of the records and know that this city is a rebellious city, hurtful to kings and provinces, and that they have stirred up sedition within it from of old. That was why this city was laid waste.
- 16 *We certify the king that, if this city be builded again, and the walls thereof set up, by this means thou shalt have no portion on this side the river.* We make known to the king that if this city is rebuilt and its walls finished, you will then have no possession in the province Beyond the River."
- 17 *Then sent the king an answer unto Rehum the chancellor, and to Shimshai the scribe, and to the rest of their companions that dwell in Samaria, and unto the rest beyond the river, Peace, and at such a time.* Then the king sent an answer to Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai the scribe and the rest of their companions that dwell in Samaria, and to the rest beyond the river: Peace, and at such a time.
- 18 *The letter which ye sent unto us hath been plainly read before me.* The letter that you sent to us has been plainly read before me.

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| <p>19 <i>And I commanded, and search hath been made, and it is found that this city of old time hath made insurrection against kings, and that rebellion and sedition have been made therein.</i></p> <p>20 <i>There have been mighty kings also over Jerusalem, which have ruled over all countries beyond the river; and toll, tribute, and custom, was paid unto them.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Give ye now commandment to cause these men to cease, and that this city be not builded, until another commandment shall be given from me.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Take heed now that ye fail not to do this: why should damage grow to the hurt of the kings?</i></p> <p>23 <i>Now when the copy of king Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum, and Shimshai the scribe, and their companions, they went up in haste to Jerusalem unto the Jews, and made them to cease by force and power.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Then ceased the work of the house of God which is at Jerusalem. So it ceased unto the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.</i></p> | <p>I made a decree, and search has been made. It has been found that this city from of old has risen against kings, and that rebellion and sedition have been made in it.</p> <p>Mighty kings have been over Jerusalem, who ruled over the whole province Beyond the River, to whom tribute, custom, and toll were paid.</p> <p>Therefore make a decree that these men be made to cease, and that this city be not rebuilt, until a decree is made by me.</p> <p>Be careful not to be slack in this matter. Why should damage grow to the hurt of the kings?"</p> <p>Then, when the copy of King Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum and Shimshai the scribe and their associates, they went in haste to Jerusalem to the Jews and forcibly made them stop.</p> <p>Then the work on the house of God that is in Jerusalem stopped. It ceased until the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Kgs 19:37; 2 Kgs 17:24
 v3 — Neh 2:20
 v4 — Ezra 3:3; Neh 6:9; Jer 38:4
 v7 — 2 Kgs 18:26; Dan 2:4
 v9 — Ezra 6:6; Ezra 5:6; 2 Kgs 17:24
 v13 — Ezra 7:24
 v20 — 1 Kgs 4:21; Gen 15:18

Chapter 5

Haggai and Zechariah prophesied to the Jews, and Zerubbabel and Jeshua resumed building the temple. Tattenai the governor questioned their authority and wrote to Darius asking whether Cyrus had indeed issued a decree.

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| <p>1 <i>Then the prophets, Haggai the prophet, and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied unto the Jews that were in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel, even unto them.</i></p> | <p>Now the prophets, Haggai and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied to the Jews who were in Judah and Jerusalem, in the name of the God of Israel who was over them.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then rose up Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and began to build the house of God which is at Jerusalem: and with them were the prophets of God helping them.</i></p> | <p>Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and Jeshua the son of Jozadak arose and began to rebuild the house of God that is in Jerusalem, and the prophets of God were with them, supporting them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>At the same time came to them Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shetharboznai, and their companions, and said thus unto them, Who hath commanded you to build this house, and to make up this wall?</i></p> | <p>At the same time Tattenai the governor of the province Beyond the River and Shethar-bozenai and their associates came to them and spoke to them thus: "Who gave you a decree to build this house and to finish this structure?"</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then said we unto them after this manner, What are the names of the men that make this building?</i></p> | <p>They also asked them this: "What are the names of the men who are building this building?"</p> |

- 5 *But the eye of their God was upon the elders of the Jews, that they could not cause them to cease, till the matter came to Darius: and then they returned answer by letter concerning this matter.* But the eye of their God was on the elders of the Jews. They did not stop them until the report should reach Darius and then an answer be returned by letter concerning it.
- 6 *The copy of the letter that Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shetharboznai, and his companions the Apharsachites, which were on this side the river, sent unto Darius the king:* This is a copy of the letter that Tatnai the governor on this side the river, and Shetharboznai, and his companions the Apharsachites, which were on this side the river, sent to Darius the king.
- 7 *They sent a letter unto him, wherein was written thus; Unto Darius the king, all peace.* They sent him a report, in which was written as follows: "To Darius the king, all peace.
- 8 *Be it known unto the king, that we went into the province of Judea, to the house of the great God, which is builded with great stones, and timber is laid in the walls, and this work goeth fast on, and prospereth in their hands.* Be it known to the king that we went to the province of Judah, to the house of the great God. It is being built with huge stones, and timber is laid in the walls. This work goes on diligently and prospers in their hands.
- 9 *Then asked we those elders, and said unto them thus, Who commanded you to build this house, and to make up these walls?* Then we asked those elders and spoke to them thus: 'Who gave you a decree to build this house and to finish this structure?'
- 10 *We asked their names also, to certify thee, that we might write the names of the men that were the chief of them.* We also asked them their names, for your information, that we might write down the names of their leaders.
- 11 *And thus they returned us answer, saying, We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and build the house that was builded these many years ago, which a great king of Israel builded and set up.* This was their reply to us: 'We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth. We are rebuilding the house that was built many years ago, which a great king of Israel built and finished.

- 12 *But after that our fathers had provoked the God of heaven unto wrath, he gave them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, the Chaldean, who destroyed this house, and carried the people away into Babylon.* But because our fathers had angered the God of heaven, He gave them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, the Chaldean, who destroyed this house and carried away the people to Babylon.
- 13 *But in the first year of Cyrus the king of Babylon the same king Cyrus made a decree to build this house of God.* However, in the first year of Cyrus king of Babylon, Cyrus the king made a decree that this house of God should be rebuilt.
- 14 *And the vessels also of gold and silver of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple that was in Jerusalem, and brought them into the temple of Babylon, those did Cyrus the king take out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered unto one, whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor;* The gold and silver vessels of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar had taken out of the temple that was in Jerusalem and brought into the temple of Babylon, these Cyrus the king took out of the temple of Babylon. They were delivered to one whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor.
- 15 *And he said unto him, Take these vessels, go, carry them into the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be builded in his place.* He said to him, "Take these vessels, go and put them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be rebuilt on its site."
- 16 *Then came the same Sheshbazzar, and laid the foundation of the house of God which is in Jerusalem: and since that time even until now hath it been in building, and yet it is not finished.* Then this Sheshbazzar came and laid the foundations of the house of God that is in Jerusalem, and from that time until now it has been in building. It is not yet finished.'

- 17 *Now therefore, if it seem good to the king, let there be search made in the king's treasure house, which is there at Babylon, whether it be so, that a decree was made of Cyrus the king to build this house of God at Jerusalem, and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.*
- Therefore, if it seems good to the king, let search be made in the royal archives there in Babylon, to see whether a decree was issued by Cyrus the king for the rebuilding of this house of God in Jerusalem. And let the king send us his pleasure in this matter."

Words in this chapter:

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Zerubbabel (*zeh-RUB-ah-bel*) — The governor who led the first return of exiles from Babylon — laid the foundation of the second temple; his name means 'born in Babylon' or 'seed of Babylon.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Zech 4:6-10; Hag 1:1-2:1

v2 — Ezra 3:2; Ezra 6:14

v3 — Ezra 6:6

v5 — Ps 33:18; Ezra 7:28; Ezra 7:6

v14 — Ezra 6:5

v16 — Ezra 3:10; Ezra 6:15

Chapter 6

Darius found Cyrus's decree in the archives and ordered the temple work to continue with full support from the royal treasury. The temple was completed and dedicated with joy, and the returned exiles kept the Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread.

- 1 *Then Darius the king made a decree, and search was made in the house of the rolls, where the treasures were laid up in Babylon.*
- Then Darius the king made a decree, and search was made in Babylon, in the house of the archives where documents were stored.

- 2 *And there was found at Achmetha, in the palace that is in the province of the Medes, a roll, and therein was a record thus written:* In Ecbatana, the citadel that is in the province of Media, a scroll was found on which this was written: "A record.
- 3 *In the first year of Cyrus the king the same Cyrus the king made a decree concerning the house of God at Jerusalem, Let the house be builded, the place where they offered sacrifices, and let the foundations thereof be strongly laid; the height thereof threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof threescore cubits;* In the first year of Cyrus the king, Cyrus the king issued a decree: Concerning the house of God at Jerusalem, let the house be rebuilt, the place where sacrifices were offered, and let its foundations be retained. Its height shall be sixty cubits and its breadth sixty cubits,
- 4 *With three rows of great stones, and a row of new timber: and let the expenses be given out of the king's house:* With three layers of great stones and one layer of timber. Let the cost be paid from the royal treasury.
- 5 *And also let the golden and silver vessels of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took forth out of the temple which is at Jerusalem, and brought unto Babylon, be restored, and brought again unto the temple which is at Jerusalem, every one to his place, and place them in the house of God.* Also let the gold and silver vessels of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple in Jerusalem and brought to Babylon, be restored and brought back to the temple in Jerusalem, each to its place. You shall put them in the house of God."
- 6 *Now therefore, Tatnai, governor beyond the river, Shetharboznai, and your companions the Apharsachites, which are beyond the river, be ye far from thence:* "Now therefore, Tatnai, governor beyond the river, Shetharboznai, and your companions the Apharsachites, which are beyond the river, keep away from there.
- 7 *Let the work of this house of God alone; let the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews build this house of God in his place.* Let the work on this house of God alone. Let the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews rebuild this house of God on its site.

- 8 *Moreover I make a decree what ye shall do to the elders of these Jews for the building of this house of God: that of the king's goods, even of the tribute beyond the river, forthwith expenses be given unto these men, that they be not hindered.* Moreover, I make a decree regarding what you shall do for these elders of the Jews for the rebuilding of this house of God. The cost is to be paid to these men in full and without delay from the royal revenue, the tribute of the province Beyond the River.
- 9 *And that which they have need of, both young bullocks, and rams, and lambs, for the burnt offerings of the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the appointment of the priests which are at Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day without fail:* Whatever is needed — bulls, rams, or sheep for burnt offerings to the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, or oil, as the priests at Jerusalem require — let that be given to them day by day without fail,
- 10 *That they may offer sacrifices of sweet savours unto the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king, and of his sons.* That they may offer pleasing sacrifices to the God of heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons.
- 11 *Also I have made a decree, that whosoever shall alter this word, let timber be pulled down from his house, and being set up, let him be hanged thereon; and let his house be made a dunghill for this.* Also I make a decree: if anyone alters this edict, a beam shall be pulled out of his house. Being set up, let him be hanged on it. His house shall be made a dunghill.
- 12 *And the God that hath caused his name to dwell there destroy all kings and people, that shall put to their hand to alter and to destroy this house of God which is at Jerusalem. I Darius have made a decree; let it be done with speed.* May the God Who has caused His name to dwell there overthrow any king or people who shall put out a hand to alter this, or to destroy this house of God that is in Jerusalem. I Darius make a decree; let it be done with all diligence."

- 13 *Then Tatnai, governor on this side the river, Shetharboznai, and their companions, according to that which Darius the king had sent, so they did speedily.* Then Tatnai, governor on this side the river, Shetharboznai, and their companions, according to that which Darius the king had sent, so they did speedily.
- 14 *And the elders of the Jews builded, and they prospered through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. And they builded, and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia.* The elders of the Jews built and prospered through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. They finished their building by decree of the God of Israel and by decree of Cyrus and Darius and Artaxerxes king of Persia;
- 15 *And this house was finished on the third day of the month Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king.* This house was finished on the third day of the month of Adar, in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king.
- 16 *And the children of Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity, kept the dedication of this house of God with joy,* The people of Israel, the priests and the Levites, and the rest of the returned exiles, celebrated the dedication of this house of God with joy.
- 17 *And offered at the dedication of this house of God an hundred bullocks, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs; and for a sin offering for all Israel, twelve he goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.* They offered at the dedication of this house of God one hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs, and as a sin offering for all Israel twelve male goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.
- 18 *And they set the priests in their divisions, and the Levites in their courses, for the service of God, which is at Jerusalem; as it is written in the book of Moses.* They set the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their divisions, for the service of God at Jerusalem, as it is written in the Book of Moses.

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| <p>19 <i>And the children of the captivity kept the passover upon the fourteenth day of the first month.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For the priests and the Levites were purified together, all of them were pure, and killed the passover for all the children of the captivity, and for their brethren the priests, and for themselves.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And the children of Israel, which were come again out of captivity, and all such as had separated themselves unto them from the filthiness of the heathen of the land, to seek the LORD God of Israel, did eat,</i></p> <p>22 <i>And kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy: for the LORD had made them joyful, and turned the heart of the king of Assyria unto them, to strengthen their hands in the work of the house of God, the God of Israel.</i></p> | <p>On the fourteenth day of the first month, the returned exiles kept the Passover.</p> <p>For the priests and the Levites had purified themselves together; all of them were clean. So they slaughtered the Passover lamb for all the returned exiles, for their fellow priests, and for themselves.</p> <p>It was eaten by the people of Israel who had returned from exile, and also by everyone who had joined them and separated Himself from the uncleanness of the peoples of the land to worship the LORD, the God of Israel.</p> <p>They kept the Feast of Unleavened Bread seven days with joy, for the LORD had made them joyful and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria to them, so that he aided them in the work of the house of God, the God of Israel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ezra 5:17

v4 — 1 Kgs 6:36

v5 — Dan 5:2; Ezra 5:14

v6 — Ezra 5:3

v11 — Dan 3:29; Ezra 7:26

v12 — 1 Kgs 9:3; Deut 12:5

- v14 — Ezra 7:1
- v16 — 2 Chr 7:5; 1 Kgs 8:63
- v17 — Ezra 8:35
- v18 — Num 3:6
- v21 — Ezra 9:11; Isa 52:11; 2 Cor 7:1; Neh 9:2; Ex 12:47-49
- v22 — Ezra 1:1; 2 Chr 30:21; Prov 21:1; Ezra 7:27; 2 Chr 35:17

Chapter 7

Ezra, a priest and scribe skilled in the law of Moses, went up from Babylon to Jerusalem in the seventh year of King Artaxerxes. The king gave him a letter authorizing him to teach the law and appoint judges, with silver and gold for the house of God.

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| 1 | <i>Now after these things, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,</i> | <i>Now after this, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,</i> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ezra** (EZ-ruh) — "help" — A priest and scribe descended from Aaron through the line of the high priests. He led the second wave of exiles from Babylon to Jerusalem under the authority of King Artaxerxes. He was devoted to studying, practicing, and teaching the Law of the LORD, and led a national repentance over the people's intermarriage with foreign nations.

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| 2 | <i>The son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,</i> | <i>The son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,</i> |
| 3 | <i>The son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,</i> | <i>The son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,</i> |
| 4 | <i>The son of Zeremiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,</i> | <i>The son of Zeremiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,</i> |
| 5 | <i>The son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest:</i> | <i>The son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest —</i> |
| 6 | <i>This Ezra went up from Babylon; and he was a ready scribe in the law of Moses, which the LORD God of Israel had given: and the king granted him all his request, according to the hand of the LORD his God upon him.</i> | <i>This Ezra went up from Babylon, and he was a ready scribe in the law of Moses, which the LORD God of Israel had given. The king granted him all his request, according to the hand of the LORD His God upon Him.</i> |

- 7 *And there went up some of the children of Israel, and of the priests, and the Levites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, unto Jerusalem, in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.* There went up also some of the children of Israel, and of the priests, and the Levites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, to Jerusalem, in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.
- 8 *And he came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king.* Ezra came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king.
- 9 *For upon the first day of the first month began he to go up from Babylon, and on the first day of the fifth month came he to Jerusalem, according to the good hand of his God upon him.* For on the first day of the first month he began to go up from Babylonia, and on the first day of the fifth month he came to Jerusalem, for the good hand of his God was on Him.
- 10 *For Ezra had prepared his heart to seek the law of the LORD, and to do it, and to teach in Israel statutes and judgments.* For Ezra had set his heart to study the Law of the LORD, and to do it and to teach His statutes and rules in Israel.
- 11 *Now this is the copy of the letter that the king Artaxerxes gave unto Ezra the priest, the scribe, even a scribe of the words of the commandments of the LORD, and of his statutes to Israel:* This is a copy of the letter that King Artaxerxes gave to Ezra the priest, the scribe, a man learned in matters of the commandments of the LORD and His statutes for Israel:
- 12 *Artaxerxes, king of kings, unto Ezra the priest, a scribe of the law of the God of heaven, perfect peace, and at such a time.* Artaxerxes, king of kings, to Ezra the priest, a scribe of the law of the God of heaven: perfect peace, and at such a time.
- 13 *I make a decree, that all they of the people of Israel, and of his priests and Levites, in my realm, which are minded of their own freewill to go up to Jerusalem, go with thee.* I make a decree that anyone of the people of Israel or their priests or Levites in my kingdom, who freely offers to go to Jerusalem, may go with you.

- 14 *Forasmuch as thou art sent of the king, and of his seven counsellors, to enquire concerning Judah and Jerusalem, according to the law of thy God which is in thine hand;* For you are sent by the king and his seven counselors to make inquiries about Judah and Jerusalem according to the Law of your God, which is in your hand,
- 15 *And to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counsellors have freely offered unto the God of Israel, whose habitation is in Jerusalem,* Also to carry the silver and gold that the king and his counselors have freely offered to the God of Israel, whose dwelling is in Jerusalem,
- 16 *And all the silver and gold that thou canst find in all the province of Babylon, with the freewill offering of the people, and of the priests, offering willingly for the house of their God which is in Jerusalem:* With all the silver and gold that you shall find in the whole province of Babylon, and with the freewill offering of the people and the priests, offered willingly for the house of their God that is in Jerusalem.
- 17 *That thou mayest buy speedily with this money bullocks, rams, lambs, with their meat offerings and their drink offerings, and offer them upon the altar of the house of your God which is in Jerusalem.* With this money, then, you shall with all diligence buy bulls, rams, and lambs, with their grain offerings and their drink offerings, and you shall offer them on the altar of the house of your God that is in Jerusalem.
- 18 *And whatsoever shall seem good to thee, and to thy brethren, to do with the rest of the silver and the gold, that do after the will of your God.* Whatever seems good to you and your brothers to do with the rest of the silver and gold, you may do, according to the will of your God.
- 19 *The vessels also that are given thee for the service of the house of thy God, those deliver thou before the God of Jerusalem.* The vessels that have been given you for the service of the house of your God, You shall deliver before the God of Jerusalem.
- 20 *And whatsoever more shall be needful for the house of thy God, which thou shalt have occasion to bestow, bestow it out of the king's treasure house.* Whatever else is required for the house of your God, which it falls to you to provide, you may provide it out of the king's treasury.

- 21 *And I, even I Artaxerxes the king, do make a decree to all the treasurers which are beyond the river, that whatsoever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, shall require of you, it be done speedily,* I, Artaxerxes the king, make a decree to all the treasurers in the province Beyond the River: Whatever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the Law of the God of heaven, requires of you, let it be done with all diligence,
- 22 *Unto an hundred talents of silver, and to an hundred measures of wheat, and to an hundred baths of wine, and to an hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much.* Up to one hundred talents of silver, one hundred cors of wheat, one hundred baths of wine, one hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much.
- 23 *Whatsoever is commanded by the God of heaven, let it be diligently done for the house of the God of heaven: for why should there be wrath against the realm of the king and his sons?* Whatever is decreed by the God of heaven, let it be done in full for the house of the God of heaven, lest His wrath be against the realm of the king and his sons.
- 24 *Also we certify you, that touching any of the priests and Levites, singers, porters, Nethinims, or ministers of this house of God, it shall not be lawful to impose toll, tribute, or custom, upon them.* We also notify you that it shall not be lawful to impose tribute, custom, or toll on anyone of the priests, the Levites, the singers, the gatekeepers, the temple servants, or other servants of this house of God.
- 25 *And thou, Ezra, after the wisdom of thy God, that is in thine hand, set magistrates and judges, which may judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and teach ye them that know them not.* You, Ezra, according to the wisdom of your God that is in your hand, appoint magistrates and judges who may judge all the people in the province Beyond the River, all such as know the laws of your God. And those who do not know them, you shall teach.
- 26 *And whosoever will not do the law of thy God, and the law of the king, let judgment be executed speedily upon him, whether it be unto death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment.* Whoever will not obey the law of your God and the law of the king, let judgment be strictly executed on him, whether death or banishment or confiscation of his goods or imprisonment."

- 27 *Blessed be the LORD God of our fathers, which hath put such a thing as this in the king's heart, to beautify the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem:* Blessed be the LORD, the God of our fathers, who put such a thing as this into the heart of the king, to beautify the house of the LORD that is in Jerusalem,
- 28 *And hath extended mercy unto me before the king, and his counsellors, and before all the king's mighty princes. And I was strengthened as the hand of the LORD my God was upon me, and I gathered together out of Israel chief men to go up with me.* Who extended to me His mercy before the king and his counselors, and before all the king's mighty officers. I took courage, for the hand of the LORD my God was on me. I gathered leading men from Israel to go up with me.

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Ezra (*EZ-rah*) — A priest and scribe who led a group of exiles back from Babylon — restored the Law among the returned community; his name means 'help.'

Phinehas (*FIN-ee-as*) — Aaron's grandson, son of Eleazar — his zeal for God stopped a plague; received a covenant of perpetual priesthood; his name may mean 'dark-skinned.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Neh 2:1
- v6 — Ezra 8:22; Ezra 7:28; Ezra 8:31; Neh 2:18; Neh 2:8
- v9 — Ezra 7:6; Neh 2:8
- v10 — 2 Tim 4:2; Mal 2:7; Matt 7:24; John 13:17; Ps 1:2
- v12 — Ezek 26:7; Dan 2:37
- v15 — Ps 135:21; 2 Chr 6:2
- v17 — Deut 12:5-11
- v20 — Ezra 6:4
- v25 — Deut 16:18; Ezra 7:10
- v26 — Ezra 6:11; Deut 13:1-18
- v27 — Ezra 6:22; Rev 17:17; Isa 60:13
- v28 — 2 Tim 4:17-18; Ezra 8:18; Ezra 5:5; Gen 32:28; Ezra 9:9

Chapter 8

Ezra listed the heads of families who returned with him from Babylon, including Levites he specially recruited. He proclaimed a fast for safe travel, refusing a military escort, and the company arrived safely in Jerusalem with the treasures intact.

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| <p>1 <i>These are now the chief of their fathers, and this is the genealogy of them that went up with me from Babylon, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Of the sons of Phinehas; Gershom: of the sons of Ithamar; Daniel: of the sons of David; Hattush.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Of the sons of Shechaniah, of the sons of Pharosh; Zechariah: and with him were reckoned by genealogy of the males an hundred and fifty.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Of the sons of Pahathmoab; Elihoenai the son of Zerahiah, and with him two hundred males.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Of the sons of Shechaniah; the son of Jahaziel, and with him three hundred males.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Of the sons also of Adin; Ebed the son of Jonathan, and with him fifty males.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And of the sons of Elam; Jeshaiiah the son of Athaliah, and with him seventy males.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And of the sons of Shephatiah; Zebadiah the son of Michael, and with him fourscore males.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Of the sons of Joab; Obadiah the son of Jehiel, and with him two hundred and eighteen males.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And of the sons of Shelomith; the son of Josiphiah, and with him an hundred and threescore males.</i></p> | <p>These are the heads of their fathers' houses, and this is the genealogy of those who went up with me from Babylonia, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king:</p> <p>Of the sons of Phinehas, Gershom. Of the sons of Ithamar, Daniel. Of the sons of David, Hattush.</p> <p>Of the sons of Shecaniah, who was of the sons of Parosh, Zechariah, with whom were registered one hundred fifty men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Pahath-moab, Eliehoenai the son of Zerahiah, and with him two hundred men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Shechaniah, the son of Jahaziel, and with him three hundred men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Adin, Ebed the son of Jonathan, and with him fifty men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Elam, Jeshaiiah the son of Athaliah, and with him seventy men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Shephatiah, Zebadiah the son of Michael, and with him eighty men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Joab, Obadiah the son of Jehiel, and with him two hundred eighteen men.</p> <p>Of the sons of Shelomith, the son of Josiphiah, and with him one hundred sixty men.</p> |
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- 11 *And of the sons of Bebai; Zechariah the son of Bebai, and with him twenty and eight males.* Of the sons of Bebai, Zechariah the son of Bebai, and with him twenty-eight men.
- 12 *And of the sons of Azgad; Johanan the son of Hakkatan, and with him an hundred and ten males.* Of the sons of Azgad, Johanan the son of Hakkatan, and with him one hundred ten men.
- 13 *And of the last sons of Adonikam, whose names are these, Eliphelet, Jeiel, and Shemaiah, and with them threescore males.* Of the sons of Adonikam, those who came last, their names being Eliphelet, Jeuel, and Shemaiah, and with them sixty men.
- 14 *Of the sons also of Bigvai; Uthai, and Zabbud, and with them seventy males.* Of the sons of Bigvai, Uthai and Zaccur, and with them seventy men.
- 15 *And I gathered them together to the river that runneth to Ahava; and there abode we in tents three days: and I viewed the people, and the priests, and found there none of the sons of Levi.* I gathered them to the river that runs to Ahava, and there we camped three days. As I reviewed the people and the priests, I found there none of the sons of Levi.
- 16 *Then sent I for Eliezer, for Ariel, for Shemaiah, and for Elnathan, and for Jarib, and for Elnathan, and for Nathan, and for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, chief men; also for Joiarib, and for Elnathan, men of understanding.* Then I sent for Eliezer, Ariel, Shemaiah, Elnathan, Jarib, Elnathan, Nathan, Zechariah, and Meshullam, who were leading men, and for Joiarib and Elnathan, who were men of insight.
- 17 *And I sent them with commandment unto Iddo the chief at the place Casiphia, and I told them what they should say unto Iddo, and to his brethren the Nethinims, at the place Casiphia, that they should bring unto us ministers for the house of our God.* I sent them to Iddo, the leading man at the place Casiphia, telling them what to say to Iddo and his brothers and the temple servants at the place Casiphia, namely, to send us ministers for the house of our God.

- 18 *And by the good hand of our God upon us they brought us a man of understanding, of the sons of Mahli, the son of Levi, the son of Israel; and Sherebiah, with his sons and his brethren, eighteen;* By the good hand of our God on us, they brought us a man of discretion, of the sons of Mahli the son of Levi, son of Israel, namely Sherebiah with His sons and kinsmen, eighteen;
- 19 *And Hashabiah, and with him Jeshaiah of the sons of Merari, his brethren and their sons, twenty;* Also Hashabiah, and with him Jeshaiah of the sons of Merari, with his kinsmen and their sons, twenty;
- 20 *Also of the Nethinims, whom David and the princes had appointed for the service of the Levites, two hundred and twenty Nethinims: all of them were expressed by name.* Besides two hundred twenty of the temple servants, whom David and his officials had set apart to attend the Levites. These were all mentioned by name.
- 21 *Then I proclaimed a fast there, at the river of Ahava, that we might afflict ourselves before our God, to seek of him a right way for us, and for our little ones, and for all our substance.* Then I proclaimed a fast there, at the river Ahava, that we might humble ourselves before our God, to seek from Him a right way for us, and for our little ones, and for all our substance.
- 22 *For I was ashamed to require of the king a band of soldiers and horsemen to help us against the enemy in the way: because we had spoken unto the king, saying, The hand of our God is upon all them for good that seek him; but his power and his wrath is against all them that forsake him.* For I was ashamed to ask the king for a band of soldiers and horsemen to protect us against the enemy on our way, since we had told the king, "The hand of our God is for good on all who seek Him, and the power of His wrath is against all who forsake Him."
- 23 *So we fasted and besought our God for this: and he was intreated of us.* So we fasted and implored our God for this. He listened to our entreaty.
- 24 *Then I separated twelve of the chief of the priests, Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their brethren with them,* Then I set apart twelve of the leading priests: Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their kinsmen with them.

- 25 *And weighed unto them the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, even the offering of the house of our God, which the king, and his counsellors, and his lords, and all Israel there present, had offered:* I weighed out to them the silver and the gold and the vessels, the offering for the house of our God that the king and his counselors and his lords and all Israel there present had offered.
- 26 *I even weighed unto their hand six hundred and fifty talents of silver, and silver vessels an hundred talents, and of gold an hundred talents;* I weighed out into their hands six hundred fifty talents of silver, and silver vessels worth a hundred talents, and a hundred talents of gold,
- 27 *Also twenty basons of gold, of a thousand drams; and two vessels of fine copper, precious as gold.* Twenty bowls of gold worth a thousand darics, and two vessels of fine bright bronze as precious as gold.
- 28 *And I said unto them, Ye are holy unto the LORD; the vessels are holy also; and the silver and the gold are a freewill offering unto the LORD God of your fathers.* I said to them, "You are holy to the LORD, and the vessels are holy, and the silver and the gold are a freewill offering to the LORD, the God of Your fathers.
- 29 *Watch ye, and keep them, until ye weigh them before the chief of the priests and the Levites, and chief of the fathers of Israel, at Jerusalem, in the chambers of the house of the LORD.* Guard them and keep them until You weigh them before the chief priests and the Levites and the heads of fathers' houses in Israel at Jerusalem, within the chambers of the house of the LORD."
- 30 *So took the priests and the Levites the weight of the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem unto the house of our God.* So the priests and the Levites took over the weight of the silver and the gold and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem, to the house of our God.
- 31 *Then we departed from the river of Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month, to go unto Jerusalem: and the hand of our God was upon us, and he delivered us from the hand of the enemy, and of such as lay in wait by the way.* Then we departed from the river Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month, to go to Jerusalem. The hand of our God was on us. He delivered us from the hand of the enemy and from ambushes on the way.

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| 32 | <i>And we came to Jerusalem, and abode there three days.</i> | We came to Jerusalem and stayed there three days. |
| 33 | <i>Now on the fourth day was the silver and the gold and the vessels weighed in the house of our God by the hand of Meremoth the son of Uriah the priest; and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas; and with them was Jozabad the son of Jeshua, and Noadiah the son of Binnui, Levites;</i> | On the fourth day, within the house of our God, the silver and the gold and the vessels were weighed into the hands of Meremoth the priest, son of Uriah, and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas, and with them were the Levites, Jozabad the son of Jeshua and Noadiah the son of Binnui. |
| 34 | <i>By number and by weight of every one: and all the weight was written at that time.</i> | The whole was counted and weighed, and the weight of everything was recorded. |
| 35 | <i>Also the children of those that had been carried away, which were come out of the captivity, offered burnt offerings unto the God of Israel, twelve bullocks for all Israel, ninety and six rams, seventy and seven lambs, twelve he goats for a sin offering: all this was a burnt offering unto the LORD.</i> | At that time those who had come from captivity, the returned exiles, offered burnt offerings to the God of Israel, twelve bulls for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, and as a sin offering twelve male goats. All this was a burnt offering to the LORD. |
| 36 | <i>And they delivered the king's commissions unto the king's lieutenants, and to the governors on this side the river: and they furthered the people, and the house of God.</i> | They also delivered the king's commissions to the king's satraps and to the governors of the province Beyond the River. They aided the people and the house of God. |

Words in this chapter:

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Ezra 2:3
- v15 — Ezra 7:7; Ezra 8:21; Ezra 8:31
- v20 — Ezra 2:43
- v21 — 2 Chr 20:3; Joel 1:14; Isa 30:21; 1 Sam 7:6; Jonah 3:5
- v22 — 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 33:18-19; 2 Chr 16:9; Ps 34:15-16; Lam 3:25
- v23 — Jer 29:12-13; Matt 7:7-8; 2 Chr 33:12-13; Ezra 8:31; Deut 4:29
- v28 — Lev 22:2-3
- v32 — Neh 2:11
- v33 — Neh 3:4
- v35 — Ezra 6:17

Chapter 9

Ezra learned that the people, priests, and Levites had intermarried with the surrounding pagan nations. He tore his garments and fell on his face before God, praying a confession of guilt and shame for the nation's unfaithfulness.

- 1 *Now when these things were done, the princes came to me, saying, The people of Israel, and the priests, and the Levites, have not separated themselves from the people of the lands, doing according to their abominations, even of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.* After these things had been done, the officials approached me and said, "The people of Israel and the priests and the Levites have not separated themselves from the peoples of the lands, doing according to their abominations, those of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.
- 2 *For they have taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sons: so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands: yea, the hand of the princes and rulers hath been chief in this trespass.* For they have taken of their daughters for themselves and for their sons, so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands. And the hand of the princes and rulers has been chief in this trespass."

- 3 *And when I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and plucked off the hair of my head and of my beard, and sat down astonished.* As soon as I heard this, I tore my garment and my cloak and pulled hair from my head and beard and sat appalled.
- 4 *Then were assembled unto me every one that trembled at the words of the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that had been carried away; and I sat astonished until the evening sacrifice.* Then all who trembled at the words of the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that had been carried away, gathered to me while I sat astonished until the evening sacrifice.
- 5 *And at the evening sacrifice I arose up from my heaviness; and having rent my garment and my mantle, I fell upon my knees, and spread out my hands unto the LORD my God,* At the evening sacrifice I rose from my fasting, with my garment and my cloak torn, and fell on my knees and spread out my hands to the LORD my God,
- 6 *And said, O my God, I am ashamed and blush to lift up my face to thee, my God: for our iniquities are increased over our head, and our trespass is grown up unto the heavens.* Saying: "O my God, I am ashamed and blush to lift my face to You, my God, for our iniquities have risen higher than our heads, and our guilt has mounted up to the heavens.
- 7 *Since the days of our fathers have we been in a great trespass unto this day; and for our iniquities have we, our kings, and our priests, been delivered into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to captivity, and to a spoil, and to confusion of face, as it is this day.* From the days of our fathers to this day we have been in great guilt. And for our iniquities we, our kings, and our priests have been given into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to captivity, to plundering, and to utter shame, as it is today.
- 8 *And now for a little space grace hath been shewed from the LORD our God, to leave us a remnant to escape, and to give us a nail in his holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes, and give us a little reviving in our bondage.* But now for a little space grace has been shown from the LORD our God, to leave us a remnant to escape, and to give us a nail in His holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes and give us a little reviving in our bondage.

- 9 *For we were bondmen; yet our God hath not forsaken us in our bondage, but hath extended mercy unto us in the sight of the kings of Persia, to give us a reviving, to set up the house of our God, and to repair the desolations thereof, and to give us a wall in Judah and in Jerusalem.* For we are slaves. Yet our God has not forsaken us in our slavery, but has extended to us His mercy before the kings of Persia, to grant us some reviving to set up the house of our God, to repair its ruins, and to give us protection in Judah and Jerusalem.
- 10 *And now, O our God, what shall we say after this? for we have forsaken thy commandments,* Now, O our God, what shall we say after this? For we have forsaken Your commandments,
- 11 *Which thou hast commanded by thy servants the prophets, saying, The land, unto which ye go to possess it, is an unclean land with the filthiness of the people of the lands, with their abominations, which have filled it from one end to another with their uncleanness.* Which You commanded by Your servants the prophets, saying, "The land that You are entering, to take possession of it, is a land impure with the impurity of the peoples of the lands, with their abominations that have filled it from end to end with their uncleanness.
- 12 *Now therefore give not your daughters unto their sons, neither take their daughters unto your sons, nor seek their peace or their wealth for ever: that ye may be strong, and eat the good of the land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children for ever.* Therefore do not give Your daughters to their sons, neither take their daughters for Your sons, and never seek their peace or prosperity, that You may be strong and eat the good of the land and leave it for an inheritance to Your children forever.'
- 13 *And after all that is come upon us for our evil deeds, and for our great trespass, seeing that thou our God hast punished us less than our iniquities deserve, and hast given us such deliverance as this;* After all that has come upon us for our evil deeds and for our great guilt, seeing that You, our God, have punished us less than our iniquities deserved and have given us such a remnant as this,

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| <p>14 <i>Should we again break thy commandments, and join in affinity with the people of these abominations? wouldst not thou be angry with us till thou hadst consumed us, so that there should be no remnant nor escaping?</i></p> <p>15 <i>O LORD God of Israel, thou art righteous: for we remain yet escaped, as it is this day: behold, we are before thee in our trespasses: for we cannot stand before thee because of this.</i></p> | <p>Shall we break Your commandments again and intermarry with the peoples who practice these abominations? Would You not be angry with us until You consumed us, so that there should be no remnant, nor any to escape?</p> <p>O LORD, the God of Israel, You are just, for we are left a remnant that has escaped, as it is today. We are before You in our guilt, for none can stand before You because of this."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

Canaanites (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.

Hittites (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.

Jebusites (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Moabites (*MO-ah-bytes*) — The people of Moab, descendants of Lot's son — Ruth was a Moabite; Israel was forbidden from destroying Moab because of their kinship with Lot.

Perizzites (*PEHR-ih-zytes*) — One of the peoples of Canaan — mentioned alongside the other Canaanite nations that Israel was to drive out; their name may mean 'village dwellers.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Lev 18:24-30; Neh 9:2

v2 — Neh 13:23-24; Ezra 10:18-44; Ezra 10:2; Ex 34:16; Deut 7:1-4

v4 — Ezra 10:3; Isa 66:2

v5 — 1 Kgs 8:38; 1 Kgs 8:22; 1 Kgs 8:54; Ex 9:29; Ex 9:33

v6 — Rev 18:5; Ps 38:4; 2 Chr 28:9; Ezra 9:15; Luke 15:21

v8 — Ps 13:3; Rom 11:5-6; Hos 6:2; Ps 85:6; Ezek 37:11-14

v9 — Ezra 7:6; Ps 136:23-24

v11 — Lev 18:24-30

v12 — Deut 7:3; Deut 23:6; Josh 23:12-13; Prov 13:22; Ex 34:15-16

v13 — Ps 103:10; Lam 3:39-40; Lam 3:22; Job 11:6

v14 — Deut 9:8; Deut 9:14; Ezra 9:2

v15 — Ps 130:3; John 8:24

Chapter 10

The people gathered to Ezra weeping, and Shecaniah proposed a covenant to put away the foreign wives. Ezra made the leaders swear to it; a great assembly gathered in Jerusalem, and within three months the investigation was completed and the guilty were listed.

- 1 *Now when Ezra had prayed, and when he had confessed, weeping and casting himself down before the house of God, there assembled unto him out of Israel a very great congregation of men and women and children: for the people wept very sore.* While Ezra prayed and made confession, weeping and casting himself down before the house of God, a very great assembly of men, women, and children gathered to Him out of Israel, for the people wept bitterly.
- 2 *And Shecaniah the son of Jehiel, one of the sons of Elam, answered and said unto Ezra, We have trespassed against our God, and have taken strange wives of the people of the land: yet now there is hope in Israel concerning this thing.* Shecaniah the son of Jehiel, of the sons of Elam, addressed Ezra: "We have broken faith with our God and have married foreign women from the peoples of the land, but even now there is hope for Israel in spite of this.
- 3 *Now therefore let us make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives, and such as are born of them, according to the counsel of my lord, and of those that tremble at the commandment of our God; and let it be done according to the law.* Therefore let us make a covenant with our God to put away all these wives and their children, according to the counsel of my lord and of those who tremble at the commandment of our God, and let it be done according to the Law.
- 4 *Arise; for this matter belongeth unto thee: we also will be with thee: be of good courage, and do it.* Arise, for it is your task. We are with you; be strong and do it."

- 5 *Then arose Ezra, and made the chief priests, the Levites, and all Israel, to swear that they should do according to this word. And they sware.* Then Ezra arose and made the leading priests and Levites and all Israel take an oath that they would do as had been said. So they took the oath.
- 6 *Then Ezra rose up from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Johanan the son of Eliashib: and when he came thither, he did eat no bread, nor drink water: for he mourned because of the transgression of them that had been carried away.* Then Ezra rose up from before the house of God and went into the chamber of Johanan the son of Eliashib. And when He came there, He did eat no bread, nor drink water, for He mourned because of the transgression of them that had been carried away.
- 7 *And they made proclamation throughout Judah and Jerusalem unto all the children of the captivity, that they should gather themselves together unto Jerusalem;* A proclamation was made throughout Judah and Jerusalem to all the returned exiles that they should assemble at Jerusalem,
- 8 *And that whosoever would not come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his substance should be forfeited, and himself separated from the congregation of those that had been carried away.* That whoever did not come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his substance should be forfeited, and himself separated from the congregation of those that had been carried away.
- 9 *Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered themselves together unto Jerusalem within three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month; and all the people sat in the street of the house of God, trembling because of this matter, and for the great rain.* Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin assembled at Jerusalem within the three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month. And all the people sat in the open square before the house of God, trembling because of this matter and because of the heavy rain.

- 10 *And Ezra the priest stood up, and said unto them, Ye have transgressed, and have taken strange wives, to increase the guilt of Israel.* Ezra the priest stood up and said to them, "You have broken faith and married foreign women, and so increased the guilt of Israel.
- 11 *Now therefore make confession unto the LORD God of your fathers, and do his pleasure: and separate yourselves from the people of the land, and from the strange wives.* Now then make confession to the LORD, the God of Your fathers and do His will. Separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from the foreign wives."
- 12 *Then all the congregation answered and said with a loud voice, As thou hast said, so must we do.* Then all the assembly answered with a loud voice, "It is so; we must do as You have said.
- 13 *But the people are many, and it is a time of much rain, and we are not able to stand without, neither is this a work of one day or two: for we are many that have transgressed in this thing.* But the people are many. It is a time of heavy rain; we cannot stand in the open. Nor is this a task for one day or for two, for we have greatly transgressed in this matter.
- 14 *Let now our rulers of all the congregation stand, and let all them which have taken strange wives in our cities come at appointed times, and with them the elders of every city, and the judges thereof, until the fierce wrath of our God for this matter be turned from us.* Let our officials stand for the whole assembly. Let all in our cities who have taken foreign wives come at appointed times, and with them the elders and judges of every city, until the fierce wrath of our God over this matter is turned away from us."
- 15 *Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahaziah the son of Tikvah were employed about this matter: and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them.* Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahaziah the son of Tikvah were employed about this matter, and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them.

- 16 *And the children of the captivity did so. And Ezra the priest, with certain chief of the fathers, after the house of their fathers, and all of them by their names, were separated, and sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter.* Then the children of the captivity did so. And Ezra the priest, with certain chief of the fathers, after the house of their fathers, and all of them by their names, were separated, and sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter.
- 17 *And they made an end with all the men that had taken strange wives by the first day of the first month.* By the first day of the first month they had come to the end of all the men who had married foreign women.
- 18 *And among the sons of the priests there were found that had taken strange wives: namely, of the sons of Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren; Maaseiah, and Eliezer, and Jarib, and Gedaliah.* Now there were found some of the sons of the priests who had married foreign women: of the sons of Jeshua the son of Jozadak and his brothers: Maaseiah, Eliezer, Jarib, and Gedaliah.
- 19 *And they gave their hands that they would put away their wives; and being guilty, they offered a ram of the flock for their trespass.* They pledged themselves to put away their wives. Their guilt offering was a ram of the flock for their guilt.
- 20 *And of the sons of Immer; Hanani, and Zebadiah.* Of the sons of Immer: Hanani and Zebadiah.
- 21 *And of the sons of Harim; Maaseiah, and Elijah, and Shemaiah, and Jehiel, and Uziah.* Of the sons of Harim: Maaseiah, Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel, and Uziah.
- 22 *And of the sons of Pashur; Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethaneel, Jozabad, and Elasa.* Of the sons of Pashhur: Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel, Jozabad, and Elasa.
- 23 *Also of the Levites; Jozabad, and Shimei, and Kelaiah, (the same is Kelita,) Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.* Of the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei, Kelaiah (that is, Kelita), Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.

- 24 *Of the singers also; Eliashib: and of the porters; Shallum, and Telem, and Uri.* Of the singers: Eliashib. Of the gatekeepers: Shallum, Telem, and Uri.
- 25 *Moreover of Israel: of the sons of Parosh; Ramiah, and Jeziah, and Malchiah, and Miamin, and Eleazar, and Malchijah, and Benaiah.* Of Israel: of the sons of Parosh: Ramiah, and Jeziah, and Malchiah, and Miamin, and Eleazar, and Malchijah, and Benaiah.
- 26 *And of the sons of Elam; Mattaniah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, and Abdi, and Jeremoth, and Elijah.* Of the sons of Elam: Mattaniah, Zechariah, Jehiel, Abdi, Jeremoth, and Elijah.
- 27 *And of the sons of Zattu; Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, and Jeremoth, and Zabad, and Aziza.* Of the sons of Zattu: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad, and Aziza.
- 28 *Of the sons also of Bebai; Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.* Of the sons of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.
- 29 *And of the sons of Bani; Meshullam, Malluch, and Adaiah, Jashub, and Sheal, and Ramoth.* Of the sons of Bani: Meshullam, Malluch, and Adaiah, Jashub, and Sheal, and Ramoth.
- 30 *And of the sons of Pahathmoab; Adna, and Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezaleel, and Binnui, and Manasseh.* Of the sons of Pahath-moab: Adna, Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezalel, Binnui, and Manasseh.
- 31 *And of the sons of Harim; Eliezer, Ishijah, Malchiah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,* Of the sons of Harim: Eliezer, Isshijah, Malchijah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,
- 32 *Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.* Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.
- 33 *Of the sons of Hashum; Mattenai, Mattathah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei.* Of the sons of Hashum: Mattenai, Mattattah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei.
- 34 *Of the sons of Bani; Maadai, Amram, and Uel,* Of the sons of Bani: Maadai, Amram, Uel,
- 35 *Benaiah, Bedeiah, Chelluh,* Benaiah, Bedeiah, Cheluhi,
- 36 *Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,* Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,

37	<i>Mattaniah, Mattenai, and Jaasau,</i>	Mattaniah, Mattenai, Jaasu,
38	<i>And Bani, and Binnui, Shimei,</i>	Bani, Binnui, Shimei,
39	<i>And Shelemiah, and Nathan, and Adaiah,</i>	Shelemiah, Nathan, Adaiah,
40	<i>Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,</i>	Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,
41	<i>Azareel, and Shelemiah, Shemariah,</i>	Azareel, Shelemiah, Shemariah,
42	<i>Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.</i>	Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.
43	<i>Of the sons of Nebo; Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jadau, and Joel, Benaiah.</i>	Of the sons of Nebo: Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jaddai, Joel, and Benaiah.
44	<i>All these had taken strange wives: and some of them had wives by whom they had children.</i>	All these had married foreign women. Some of the women had even borne them children.

Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Ishmael (*ISH-mee-el*) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Dan 9:20; Ps 119:136; Rom 9:2; 1 John 1:8-10; 1 Kgs 8:30

v2 — Neh 13:27

v3 — Deut 7:2-3; Ezra 9:4

v4 — 1 Chr 28:10; Eccl 9:10; Heb 12:12-13; 1 Chr 22:19; Heb 10:24

v5 — Neh 13:25; Neh 5:12

v6 — Deut 9:18

v11 — Rom 12:2

v14 — 2 Chr 30:8; 2 Chr 29:10

v19 — Lev 6:6

Nehemiah

Author: Nehemiah, primarily — large sections are written in first-person memoir. Ezra the priest likely compiled or edited the final form, as Ezra-Nehemiah was originally one scroll.

Date written: c. 432–420 BC, after Nehemiah's second term as governor concluded.

Written to: The Jewish community in Jerusalem and the diaspora, to record the completion of the restoration under Nehemiah's leadership.

Setting: Nearly a century after the first exiles returned under Zerubbabel. Jerusalem's temple has been rebuilt, but the city walls lie in ruins — leaving the people defenseless and the city dishonored. Nehemiah, cupbearer to the Persian king Artaxerxes, receives word of this and obtains royal permission to go and rebuild.

Where this sits historically: The events fall in 445–433 BC under the Persian king Artaxerxes I (Longimanus), with Sanballat governing Samaria and Tobiah ruling in Ammon as Nehemiah's chief opponents.

Contemporaries: Ezra was teaching the law in Jerusalem, Malachi was prophesying against priestly corruption and mixed marriages, and the Persian empire stretched from India to the Aegean under Artaxerxes.

Big themes:

- Prayer and action — Nehemiah's response to every crisis is first to pray, then to act; the book is saturated with brief, urgent prayers
- Opposition — Sanballat, Tobiah, and Geshem use ridicule, threat, conspiracy, and compromise to stop the work; Nehemiah refuses every distraction
- The wall — rebuilding Jerusalem's walls in fifty-two days is presented as an act of God, not merely human effort
- Covenant renewal — Ezra reads the law to the assembled people (ch. 8), and the nation makes a written commitment to keep it
- Persistent reform — Nehemiah's second term (ch. 13) shows how quickly the community reverts; reform must be continually renewed

Key passages: Neh 1:5–6; 2:17–18; 4:14; 6:15–16; 8:8

How it fits: Nehemiah completes the restoration narrative that began in Ezra. Together, Ezra-Nehemiah brings the OT historical books to their close. After Nehemiah, the OT falls silent for four hundred years until John the Baptist appears. Malachi, written in this same era, ends with the promise of Elijah's return.

Chapter 1

Nehemiah, cupbearer to King Artaxerxes in Susa, received word from his brother Hanani that Jerusalem's walls were broken down and its gates burned. Nehemiah wept, fasted, and prayed, confessing Israel's sins and asking God for favor before the king.

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| <p>1 <i>The words of Nehemiah the son of Hachaliah. And it came to pass in the month Chisleu, in the twentieth year, as I was in Shushan the palace,</i></p> | <p>The words of Nehemiah the son of Hachaliah. In the month of Kislev, in the twentieth year, while I was at the citadel of Shushan,</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nehemiah** (nee-heh-MY-ah) — "the LORD comforts" — Son of Hachaliah, cupbearer to the Persian king Artaxerxes. On hearing that Jerusalem's walls lay in ruins, he obtained royal permission to rebuild them. A man of prayer and decisive action, he served as governor of Judah.

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| <p>2 <i>That Hanani, one of my brethren, came, he and certain men of Judah; and I asked them concerning the Jews that had escaped, which were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Hanani, one of my brothers, arrived with some men from Judah. I asked them about the Jews who had survived the exile, and about Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they said unto me, The remnant that are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach: the wall of Jerusalem also is broken down, and the gates thereof are burned with fire.</i></p> | <p>They said to me, "The survivors who are left from the exile in the province are in great trouble and disgrace. The wall of Jerusalem is broken down, and its gates have been burned with fire."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,</i></p> | <p>When I heard these words, I sat down and wept. I mourned for several days, fasting and praying before the God of heaven.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And said, I beseech thee, O LORD God of heaven, the great and terrible God, that keepeth covenant and mercy for them that love him and observe his commandments:</i></p> | <p>I said, "LORD, God of heaven, the great and awesome God, Who keeps His covenant and mercy with those who love Him and keep His commandments —</p> |

- 6 *Let thine ear now be attentive, and thine eyes open, that thou mayest hear the prayer of thy servant, which I pray before thee now, day and night, for the children of Israel thy servants, and confess the sins of the children of Israel, which we have sinned against thee: both I and my father's house have sinned.* let Your ear be attentive and Your eyes open, to hear the prayer Your servant prays before You day and night for the people of Israel. I confess the sins we have committed against You — yes, I and my father's house have sinned.
- 7 *We have dealt very corruptly against thee, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the judgments, which thou commandedst thy servant Moses.* We have acted very corruptly against you. We have not kept the commandments, statutes, and judgments you commanded your servant Moses.
- 8 *Remember, I beseech thee, the word that thou commandedst thy servant Moses, saying, If ye transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations:* Please remember the word you commanded your servant Moses: 'If you are unfaithful, I will scatter you among the peoples;
- 9 *But if ye turn unto me, and keep my commandments, and do them; though there were of you cast out unto the uttermost part of the heaven, yet will I gather them from thence, and will bring them unto the place that I have chosen to set my name there.* but if you return to me and keep my commandments and do them, then even if your exiles are at the farthest horizon, I will gather them from there and bring them to the place I have chosen for my name to dwell.'
- 10 *Now these are thy servants and thy people, whom thou hast redeemed by thy great power, and by thy strong hand.* These are your servants and your people, whom you have redeemed by your great power and your strong hand.

- 11 *O LORD, I beseech thee, let now thine ear be attentive to the prayer of thy servant, and to the prayer of thy servants, who desire to fear thy name: and prosper, I pray thee, thy servant this day, and grant him mercy in the sight of this man. For I was the king's cupbearer.* O Lord, please let your ear be attentive to the prayer of your servant, and to the prayer of your servants who delight to fear your name. Give your servant success today, and grant him favor in the presence of this man." For I was the king's cupbearer.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nehemiah (*nee-heh-MY-ah*) — A cupbearer to the Persian king who returned to rebuild Jerusalem's walls — a man of prayer and practical leadership; his name means 'the LORD comforts.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Zech 7:1; Neh 10:1; Esth 1:2; Dan 8:2
v2 — Neh 7:2
v3 — Neh 2:17; 2 Kgs 25:10
v4 — Dan 9:3; Ps 137:1; Ezra 10:1; Neh 2:4; Ps 69:9-10
v5 — Ex 20:6; Dan 9:4-19; Deut 7:21; Deut 7:9; Neh 4:14
v6 — Dan 9:20; Dan 9:4; Ps 34:15; Ps 106:6; Dan 9:17-18
v7 — Dan 9:5-6; Dan 9:11; Dan 9:13
v8 — Deut 28:64; Deut 4:25-27; Lev 26:33-46; 1 Kgs 9:6-7
v9 — Jer 29:11-14; Deut 30:2-5; Deut 4:29-31; Jer 32:37; Lev 26:39-42
v10 — Deut 9:29; Dan 9:15-27; Ex 32:11
v11 — Neh 1:6; Neh 2:8; Prov 21:1; Neh 2:1; Heb 13:18

Chapter 2

The king noticed Nehemiah's sadness and granted him letters and an escort to go to Jerusalem and rebuild the walls. Nehemiah inspected the ruined walls by night and rallied the people to build, despite the mockery of Sanballat, Tobiah, and Geshem.

- 1 *And it came to pass in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that wine was before him: and I took up the wine, and gave it unto the king. Now I had not been beforetime sad in his presence.* In the month of Nisan, in the twentieth year of King Artaxerxes, wine was before him. I took up the wine and gave it to the king. I had never before been sad in his presence.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Artaxerxes** (ar-tah-ZERK-seez) — "great warrior" — Artaxerxes I Longimanus, king of Persia c. 465–424 BC. He authorized both Ezra's mission (Ezra 7) and Nehemiah's governorship to rebuild Jerusalem's walls. His decree is the basis for the prophetic timeline of Daniel 9:25.

- 2 *Wherefore the king said unto me, Why is thy countenance sad, seeing thou art not sick? this is nothing else but sorrow of heart. Then I was very sore afraid,* So the king said to me, "Why is your countenance sad, since you are not sick? This can only be sadness of heart." Then I was very much afraid.
- 3 *And said unto the king, Let the king live for ever: why should not my countenance be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' sepulchres, lieth waste, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire?* I said to the king, "May the king live forever! Why should my countenance not be sad, when the city where my fathers are buried lies in ruins, and its gates have been destroyed by fire?"
- 4 *Then the king said unto me, For what dost thou make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven.* The king said to me, "What do you want?" So I prayed to the God of heaven,
- 5 *And I said unto the king, If it please the king, and if thy servant have found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldest send me unto Judah, unto the city of my fathers' sepulchres, that I may build it.* I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, and if your servant has found favor in your sight, please send me to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, so that I may rebuild it."

- 6 *And the king said unto me, (the queen also sitting by him,) For how long shall thy journey be? and when wilt thou return? So it pleased the king to send me; and I set him a time.* The king said to me (with the queen sitting beside him), "How long will your journey take, and when will you return?" It pleased the king to send me. I gave him a time.
- 7 *Moreover I said unto the king, If it please the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the river, that they may convey me over till I come into Judah;* I also said to the king, "If it pleases the king, let letters be given to me for the governors of the region beyond the River, so that they will let me pass through until I reach Judah;
- 8 *And a letter unto Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the palace which appertained to the house, and for the wall of the city, and for the house that I shall enter into. And the king granted me, according to the good hand of my God upon me.* a letter to Asaph, the keeper of the king's forest, so that he will give me timber to make beams for the gates of the fortress of the temple, for the city wall, and for the house I will occupy." The king granted these requests, for the good hand of my God was on me.
- 9 *Then I came to the governors beyond the river, and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had sent captains of the army and horsemen with me.* Then I came to the governors of the region beyond the River and gave them the king's letters. The king had also sent army officers and horsemen with me.
- 10 *When Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly that there was come a man to seek the welfare of the children of Israel.* When Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite official heard this, it troubled them greatly that someone had come to seek the welfare of the people of Israel.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sanballat** (san-BAL-at) — "Sin (the moon-god) has given life" — Governor of Samaria, a Horonite (from Beth-horon). The chief opponent of Nehemiah's rebuilding project, who used mockery, threats, conspiracy, and false accusations to try to stop the work.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tobiah** (toh-BY-ah) — "the LORD is good" — An Ammonite official allied with Sanballat against Nehemiah. Despite his Israelite-sounding name, he opposed the rebuilding and later infiltrated the temple itself, being given a chamber by the priest Eliashib (13:4–7).

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| <p>11 <i>So I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me; neither told I any man what my God had put in my heart to do at Jerusalem: neither was there any beast with me, save the beast that I rode upon.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, even before the dragon well, and to the dung port, and viewed the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and the gates thereof were consumed with fire.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then I went on to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's pool: but there was no place for the beast that was under me to pass.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Then went I up in the night by the brook, and viewed the wall, and turned back, and entered by the gate of the valley, and so returned.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the rulers knew not whither I went, or what I did; neither had I as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest that did the work.</i></p> | <p>So I came to Jerusalem and was there three days.</p> <p>Then I arose in the night, I and a few men with me. I had not told anyone what my God had put in my heart to do for Jerusalem. There was no animal with me but the one I was riding.</p> <p>I went out by night through the Valley Gate, past the Dragon Spring, and to the Refuse Gate, inspecting the walls of Jerusalem that were broken down and its gates that had been destroyed by fire.</p> <p>Then I went on to the Fountain Gate and the King's Pool, but there was no room for the animal under me to pass through.</p> <p>So I went up in the night along the valley and inspected the wall, then turned back and entered through the Valley Gate, and returned.</p> <p>The officials did not know where I had gone or what I was doing. I had not yet told the Jews, the priests, the nobles, the officials, or any of the others who would be doing the work.</p> |
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- 17 *Then said I unto them, Ye see the distress that we are in, how Jerusalem lieth waste, and the gates thereof are burned with fire: come, and let us build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we be no more a reproach.* Then I said to them, "You see the trouble we are in — how Jerusalem lies in ruins with its gates burned down. Come, let us rebuild the wall of Jerusalem so that we will no longer be a disgrace."
- 18 *Then I told them of the hand of my God which was good upon me; as also the king's words that he had spoken unto me. And they said, Let us rise up and build. So they strengthened their hands for this good work.* I also told them about the good hand of my God on me, and about the king's words that he had spoken to me. They said, "Let us rise up and build." So they committed themselves to the good work.
- 19 *But when Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they laughed us to scorn, and despised us, and said, What is this thing that ye do? will ye rebel against the king?* But when Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite official, and Geshem the Arab heard about it, they mocked and despised us, saying, "What is this thing you are doing? Are you rebelling against the king?"
- 20 *Then answered I them, and said unto them, The God of heaven, he will prosper us; therefore we his servants will arise and build: but ye have no portion, nor right, nor memorial, in Jerusalem.* I replied to them, "The God of heaven will give us success. We His servants will rise up and build. But you have no share, no right, and no claim in Jerusalem."

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezra 7:1; Neh 1:11
v3 — Neh 1:3; 1 Kgs 1:31
v4 — Phil 4:6; Prov 3:6; Neh 1:4; Neh 1:11; 1 Kgs 3:5
v7 — Ezra 7:21; Neh 2:9; Ezra 8:36
v8 — Ezra 7:6; Isa 66:14; Neh 7:2; Dan 1:9

v10 — Neh 2:19; Neh 4:7

v13 — Neh 1:3; Neh 2:3; Neh 3:13-14; Neh 2:17; 2 Chr 26:9

v14 — Neh 3:15; 2 Kgs 20:20

v17 — Ezek 5:14; Isa 35:3-4; Lam 3:45-46; Lam 3:51; Neh 1:3

v18 — Phil 2:13; 2 Chr 32:5; 1 Chr 19:13; Eph 6:10; Hag 1:13-14

v19 — Neh 6:6; Neh 6:1-2

v20 — Ezra 4:3; Acts 8:21; Neh 2:4; Acts 10:31; Isa 56:5

Chapter 3

The chapter records the sections of the wall rebuilt by each family, priest, and guild, gate by gate around the circuit of Jerusalem from the Sheep Gate back to the Sheep Gate.

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| 1 | <i>Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brethren the priests, and they builded the sheep gate; they sanctified it, and set up the doors of it; even unto the tower of Meah they sanctified it, unto the tower of Hananeel.</i> | Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his fellow priests and built the Sheep Gate. They consecrated it and set its doors in place, consecrating it as far as the Tower of the Hundred and the Tower of Hananel. |
| 2 | <i>And next unto him builded the men of Jericho. And next to them builded Zaccur the son of Imri.</i> | Next to him the men of Jericho built. And next to them Zaccur the son of Imri built. |
| 3 | <i>But the fish gate did the sons of Hassenaah build, who also laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.</i> | The sons of Hassenaah built the Fish Gate; they laid its beams and set its doors, bolts, and bars in place. |
| 4 | <i>And next unto them repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah, the son of Koz. And next unto them repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabeel. And next unto them repaired Zadok the son of Baana.</i> | Next to them Meremoth the son of Uriah, son of Hakkoz, made repairs. Next to them Meshullam the son of Berechiah, son of Meshezabel, made repairs. Next to them Zadok the son of Baana made repairs. |
| 5 | <i>And next unto them the Tekoites repaired; but their nobles put not their necks to the work of their LORD.</i> | Next to them the Tekoites made repairs, though their nobles would not stoop to serve their Lord. |

- 6 *Moreover the old gate repaired Jehoiada the son of Paseah, and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah; they laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, and the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.* Jehoiada the son of Paseah and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah repaired the Jeshanah Gate; they laid its beams and set its doors, bolts, and bars in place.
- 7 *And next unto them repaired Melatiah the Gibeonite, and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon, and of Mizpah, unto the throne of the governor on this side the river.* Next to them Melatiah the Gibeonite and Jadon the Meronothite made repairs — the men of Gibeon and Mizpah — who were under the authority of the governor of the region beyond the River.
- 8 *Next unto him repaired Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, of the goldsmiths. Next unto him also repaired Hananiah the son of one of the apothecaries, and they fortified Jerusalem unto the broad wall.* Next to him Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, one of the goldsmiths, made repairs. Next to him Hananiah, one of the perfumers, made repairs. They restored Jerusalem as far as the Broad Wall.
- 9 *And next unto them repaired Rephaiah the son of Hur, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem.* Next to them Rephaiah the son of Hur, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made repairs.
- 10 *And next unto them repaired Jedaiah the son of Harumaph, even over against his house. And next unto him repaired Hattush the son of Hashabneiah.* Next to them Jedaiah the son of Harumaph made repairs opposite his house. Next to him Hattush the son of Hashabneiah made repairs.
- 11 *Malchijah the son of Harim, and Hashub the son of Pahathmoab, repaired the other piece, and the tower of the furnaces.* Malchijah the son of Harim and Hasshub the son of Pahath-moab repaired another section and the Tower of the Ovens.
- 12 *And next unto him repaired Shallum the son of Halohesh, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem, he and his daughters.* Next to him Shallum the son of Hallohesh, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made repairs — he and his daughters.

- 13 *The valley gate repaired Hanun, and the inhabitants of Zanoah; they built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and a thousand cubits on the wall unto the dung gate.* Hanun and the inhabitants of Zanoah repaired the Valley Gate. They rebuilt it and set its doors, bolts, and bars in place, and also repaired a thousand cubits of wall to the Refuse Gate.
- 14 *But the dung gate repaired Malchiah the son of Rechab, the ruler of part of Bethhacerem; he built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.* Malchijah the son of Rechab, ruler of the district of Beth-hacerem, repaired the Refuse Gate. He rebuilt it and set its doors, bolts, and bars in place.
- 15 *But the gate of the fountain repaired Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of part of Mizpah; he built it, and covered it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and the wall of the pool of Siloah by the king's garden, even unto the stairs that go down from the city of David.* Shallun the son of Col-hozeh, ruler of the district of Mizpah, repaired the Fountain Gate. He rebuilt it, roofed it, and set its doors, bolts, and bars in place. He also repaired the wall of the Pool of Shelah near the king's garden, as far as the stairs that go down from the City of David.
- 16 *After him repaired Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, the ruler of the half part of Bethzur, unto the place over against the sepulchres of David, and to the pool that was made, and unto the house of the mighty.* After him Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, ruler of half the district of Beth-zur, made repairs as far as the tombs of David, and as far as the artificial pool and the House of the Warriors.
- 17 *After him repaired the Levites, Rehum the son of Bani. Next unto him repaired Hashabiah, the ruler of the half part of Keilah, in his part.* After him the Levites made repairs — Rehum the son of Bani. Next to him Hashabiah, ruler of half the district of Keilah, made repairs for his district.
- 18 *After him repaired their brethren, Bavai the son of Henadad, the ruler of the half part of Keilah.* After him their fellow Levites made repairs — Bavvai the son of Henadad, ruler of the other half of the district of Keilah.

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| <p>19 <i>And next to him repaired Ezer the son of Jeshua, the ruler of Mizpah, another piece over against the going up to the armoury at the turning of the wall.</i></p> <p>20 <i>After him Baruch the son of Zabbai earnestly repaired the other piece, from the turning of the wall unto the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest.</i></p> <p>21 <i>After him repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah the son of Koz another piece, from the door of the house of Eliashib even to the end of the house of Eliashib.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And after him repaired the priests, the men of the plain.</i></p> <p>23 <i>After him repaired Benjamin and Hashub over against their house. After him repaired Azariah the son of Maaseiah the son of Ananiah by his house.</i></p> <p>24 <i>After him repaired Binnui the son of Henadad another piece, from the house of Azariah unto the turning of the wall, even unto the corner.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Palal the son of Uzai, over against the turning of the wall, and the tower which lieth out from the king's high house, that was by the court of the prison. Next unto him Pedaiah the son of Parosh.</i></p> | <p>Next to him Ezer the son of Jeshua, ruler of Mizpah, repaired another section opposite the ascent to the armory at the Angle.</p> <p>After him Baruch the son of Zabbai diligently repaired another section, from the Angle to the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest.</p> <p>After him Meremoth the son of Uriah, son of Hakkoz, repaired another section, from the door of Eliashib's house to the end of it.</p> <p>After him the priests, the men of the surrounding area, made repairs.</p> <p>After them Benjamin and Hasshub made repairs opposite their house. After them Azariah the son of Maaseiah, son of Ananiah, made repairs beside his own house.</p> <p>After him Binnui the son of Henadad repaired another section, from the house of Azariah to the Angle and to the corner.</p> <p>Palal the son of Uzai made repairs opposite the Angle and the tower projecting from the upper house of the king at the court of the guard. Next to him Pedaiah the son of Parosh made repairs.</p> |
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| <p>26 <i>Moreover the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel, unto the place over against the water gate toward the east, and the tower that lieth out.</i></p> <p>27 <i>After them the Tekoites repaired another piece, over against the great tower that lieth out, even unto the wall of Ophel.</i></p> <p>28 <i>From above the horse gate repaired the priests, every one over against his house.</i></p> <p>29 <i>After them repaired Zadok the son of Immer over against his house. After him repaired also Shemaiah the son of Shechaniah, the keeper of the east gate.</i></p> <p>30 <i>After him repaired Hananiah the son of Shelemiah, and Hanun the sixth son of Zalaph, another piece. After him repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah over against his chamber.</i></p> <p>31 <i>After him repaired Malchiah the goldsmith's son unto the place of the Nethinims, and of the merchants, over against the gate Miphkad, and to the going up of the corner.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And between the going up of the corner unto the sheep gate repaired the goldsmiths and the merchants.</i></p> | <p>The temple servants living on the hill of Ophel made repairs as far as the Water Gate on the east and the projecting tower.</p> <p>After them the Tekoites repaired another section, opposite the great projecting tower as far as the wall of Ophel.</p> <p>Above the Horse Gate the priests made repairs, each one opposite his own house.</p> <p>After them Zadok the son of Immer made repairs opposite his own house. After him Shemaiah the son of Shecaniah, the keeper of the East Gate, made repairs.</p> <p>After him Hananiah the son of Shelemiah and Hanun the sixth son of Zalaph repaired another section. After him Meshullam the son of Berechiah made repairs opposite his room.</p> <p>After him Malchijah, one of the goldsmiths, made repairs as far as the house of the temple servants and the merchants, opposite the Muster Gate, and to the upper room of the corner.</p> <p>Between the upper room of the corner and the Sheep Gate the goldsmiths and merchants made repairs.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared

to him in a dream.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Neh 12:39; Jer 31:38; John 5:2; Zech 14:10

v3 — Neh 12:39; 2 Chr 33:14

v4 — Ezra 8:33

v6 — Neh 12:39

v8 — Neh 12:38

v11 — Neh 12:38

v13 — Neh 2:13

v14 — Jer 6:1

v15 — John 9:7; Isa 8:6

v25 — Jer 32:2

v26 — Neh 8:1; Neh 11:21

v28 — 2 Chr 23:15; Jer 31:40

Chapter 4

Sanballat and Tobiah mocked the rebuilding and then plotted a military attack; Nehemiah armed the workers and set half the men as guards. The builders worked with one hand and held a weapon with the other, and the work continued day and night.

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| <p>1 <i>But it came to pass, that when Sanballat heard that we builded the wall, he was wroth, and took great indignation, and mocked the Jews.</i></p> | <p>When Sanballat heard that we were rebuilding the wall, he was furious and greatly enraged. He ridiculed the Jews,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he spake before his brethren and the army of Samaria, and said, What do these feeble Jews? will they fortify themselves? will they sacrifice? will they make an end in a day? will they revive the stones out of the heaps of the rubbish which are burned?</i></p> | <p>saying before his associates and the army of Samaria, "What are these feeble Jews doing? Will they restore it by themselves? Will they offer sacrifices? Will they finish it in a day? Will they revive the stones out of the heaps of rubble — burned ones at that?"</p> |

- 3 *Now Tobiah the Ammonite was by him, and he said, Even that which they build, if a fox go up, he shall even break down their stone wall.* Tobiah the Ammonite was nearby and said, "Whatever they are building — even a fox could break down their stone wall!"
- 4 *Hear, O our God; for we are despised: and turn their reproach upon their own head, and give them for a prey in the land of captivity:* Hear us, our God, for we are despised. Turn their insults back on their own heads. Give them over as plunder in a land of captivity.
- 5 *And cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from before thee: for they have provoked thee to anger before the builders.* Cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from your sight, for they have thrown insults in the face of the builders.
- 6 *So built we the wall; and all the wall was joined together unto the half thereof: for the people had a mind to work.* So we rebuilt the wall, and the whole wall was joined together to half its height, for the people had a heart to work.
- 7 *But it came to pass, that when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and the Arabians, and the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites, heard that the walls of Jerusalem were made up, and that the breaches began to be stopped, then they were very wroth,* But when Sanballat, Tobiah, the Arabs, the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites heard that the repair of Jerusalem's walls was progressing and the gaps were being closed, they were very angry.
- 8 *And conspired all of them together to come and to fight against Jerusalem, and to hinder it.* They all plotted together to come and fight against Jerusalem and throw it into confusion.
- 9 *Nevertheless we made our prayer unto our God, and set a watch against them day and night, because of them.* But we prayed to our God and set a guard as protection against them day and night.
- 10 *And Judah said, The strength of the bearers of burdens is decayed, and there is much rubbish; so that we are not able to build the wall.* Then Judah said, "The strength of the laborers is failing; there is so much rubble that we cannot rebuild the wall."

- 11 *And our adversaries said, They shall not know, neither see, till we come in the midst among them, and slay them, and cause the work to cease.* Our enemies said, "Before they know it or see us, we will be right among them and kill them and put an end to the work."
- 12 *And it came to pass, that when the Jews which dwelt by them came, they said unto us ten times, From all places whence ye shall return unto us they will be upon you.* When the Jews who lived near them came to us, they kept warning us ten times over, "From all the places where they live they will attack us."
- 13 *Therefore set I in the lower places behind the wall, and on the higher places, I even set the people after their families with their swords, their spears, and their bows.* So I stationed men in the lower parts of the space behind the wall, in open places. I stationed them by families, with their swords, spears, and bows.
- 14 *And I looked, and rose up, and said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, Be not ye afraid of them: remember the LORD, which is great and terrible, and fight for your brethren, your sons, and your daughters, your wives, and your houses.* After looking things over I stood up and said to the nobles, the officials, and the rest of the people, "Do not be afraid of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons and daughters, your wives, and your homes."
- 15 *And it came to pass, when our enemies heard that it was known unto us, and God had brought their counsel to nought, that we returned all of us to the wall, every one unto his work.* When our enemies heard that we knew their plot and that God had frustrated it, we all returned to the wall, each to His own work.
- 16 *And it came to pass from that time forth, that the half of my servants wrought in the work, and the other half of them held both the spears, the shields, and the bows, and the habergeons; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah.* From that day on, half of my servants worked on construction while the other half held spears, shields, bows, and armor. The officers stood behind the whole house of Judah

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| <p>17 <i>They which builded on the wall, and they that bare burdens, with those that laded, every one with one of his hands wrought in the work, and with the other hand held a weapon.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For the builders, every one had his sword girded by his side, and so builded. And he that sounded the trumpet was by me.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And I said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, The work is great and large, and we are separated upon the wall, one far from another.</i></p> <p>20 <i>In what place therefore ye hear the sound of the trumpet, resort ye thither unto us: our God shall fight for us.</i></p> <p>21 <i>So we laboured in the work: and half of them held the spears from the rising of the morning till the stars appeared.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Likewise at the same time said I unto the people, Let every one with his servant lodge within Jerusalem, that in the night they may be a guard to us, and labour on the day.</i></p> <p>23 <i>So neither I, nor my brethren, nor my servants, nor the men of the guard which followed me, none of us put off our clothes, saving that every one put them off for washing.</i></p> | <p>who were building on the wall. Those who carried loads did their work with one hand holding the load and the other hand holding a weapon.</p> <p>Each builder wore his sword at his side while he worked. The man who sounded the trumpet stayed close to me.</p> <p>I said to the nobles, the officials, and the rest of the people, "The work is extensive and spread out. We are widely separated on the wall, one far from another.</p> <p>Wherever you hear the sound of the trumpet, rally to us there. Our God will fight for us."</p> <p>So we carried on the work with half of the men holding spears, from the break of dawn until the stars came out.</p> <p>At that time I also told the people, "Let every man and his servant stay inside Jerusalem at night, so that they can stand guard by night and work by day."</p> <p>So neither I, nor my brothers, nor my servants, nor the men of the guard who were with me ever took off our clothes, except every one put them off for washing.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 11:36; Neh 2:10; Ps 35:15-16; Acts 5:17; Neh 2:19
- v4 — Ps 79:12; Ps 123:3-4; Prov 3:34
- v5 — Jer 18:23; Ps 109:14; Ps 69:27-28
- v6 — Phil 2:13; Neh 6:15; 1 Chr 29:3; Heb 13:21; 1 Chr 29:14
- v7 — Neh 4:1; Neh 2:10
- v9 — 1 Pet 5:8; Acts 4:24-30; Ps 50:15
- v14 — 2 Sam 10:12; Num 14:9; Isa 41:10-14; Heb 13:6; Ps 66:3
- v15 — 2 Sam 17:14; Rom 12:11
- v20 — Ex 14:14; Deut 20:4; Deut 1:30; Deut 3:22; Josh 23:10

Chapter 5

The people cried out against the wealthy nobles who were charging interest and seizing their lands and children during the famine. Nehemiah rebuked the nobles, made them return what they had taken, and set an example by refusing the governor’s food allowance for twelve years.

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| 1 | <i>And there was a great cry of the people and of their wives against their brethren the Jews.</i> | Now there was a great outcry from the people and their wives against their fellow Jews. |
| 2 | <i>For there were that said, We, our sons, and our daughters, are many: therefore we take up corn for them, that we may eat, and live.</i> | Some were saying, "We, our sons and daughters, are many. We must get grain so that we can eat and stay alive." |
| 3 | <i>Some also there were that said, We have mortgaged our lands, vineyards, and houses, that we might buy corn, because of the dearth.</i> | Others were saying, "We are mortgaging our fields, vineyards, and houses to get grain because of the famine." |
| 4 | <i>There were also that said, We have borrowed money for the king's tribute, and that upon our lands and vineyards.</i> | Still others said, "We have had to borrow money for the king's tax on our fields and vineyards." |

- 5 *Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brethren, our children as their children: and, lo, we bring into bondage our sons and our daughters to be servants, and some of our daughters are brought unto bondage already: neither is it in our power to redeem them; for other men have our lands and vineyards.* "Now our flesh is the same as our brothers' flesh; our children are the same as theirs. Yet we are forcing our sons and daughters into slavery. Some of our daughters are already enslaved. We are powerless to help, for our fields and vineyards now belong to others."
- 6 *And I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words.* When I heard their outcry and these words, I was very angry.
- 7 *Then I consulted with myself, and I rebuked the nobles, and the rulers, and said unto them, Ye exact usury, every one of his brother. And I set a great assembly against them.* After thinking it over, I confronted the nobles and officials and said to them, "You are charging interest on loans to your own brothers!" So I called a great assembly to deal with them.
- 8 *And I said unto them, We after our ability have redeemed our brethren the Jews, which were sold unto the heathen; and will ye even sell your brethren? or shall they be sold unto us? Then held they their peace, and found nothing to answer.* I said to them, "We, as best we could, have bought back our fellow Jews who were sold to the nations. But now you are selling your own brothers. They must be bought back by us?" They were silent and could find nothing to say.
- 9 *Also I said, It is not good that ye do: ought ye not to walk in the fear of our God because of the reproach of the heathen our enemies?* So I continued, "What you are doing is not right. Should you not walk in the fear of our God, so that the reproach of our enemies will not fall on us?"
- 10 *I likewise, and my brethren, and my servants, might exact of them money and corn: I pray you, let us leave off this usury.* "I myself, my brothers, and my servants are also lending money and grain to the people. But let us stop this practice of charging interest.

- 11 *Restore, I pray you, to them, even this day, their lands, their vineyards, their oliveyards, and their houses, and also the hundredth part of the money, and of the corn, the wine, and the oil, that ye exact of them.* Please give back to them this very day their fields, vineyards, olive groves, and houses, and also the interest you are charging them — a hundredth of the money, grain, new wine, and olive oil."
- 12 *Then said they, We will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we do as thou sayest. Then I called the priests, and took an oath of them, that they should do according to this promise.* They replied, "We will restore it and will require nothing more from them. We will do exactly as you say." So I called the priests and made the nobles and officials swear an oath to do what they had promised.
- 13 *Also I shook my lap, and said, So God shake out every man from his house, and from his labour, that performeth not this promise, even thus be he shaken out, and emptied. And all the congregation said, Amen, and praised the LORD. And the people did according to this promise.* I also shook out my garment and said, "In this way may God shake out every man from his house and from his property who does not keep this promise. May He be shaken out and emptied!" And all the assembly said, "Amen," and praised the LORD. The people did as they had promised.
- 14 *Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even unto the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelve years, I and my brethren have not eaten the bread of the governor.* Furthermore, from the day I was appointed as their governor in the land of Judah — from the twentieth year to the thirty-second year of King Artaxerxes, twelve years — neither I nor my brothers ate the food allotted to the governor.
- 15 *But the former governors that had been before me were chargeable unto the people, and had taken of them bread and wine, beside forty shekels of silver; yea, even their servants bare rule over the people: but so did not I, because of the fear of God.* The earlier governors who preceded me had placed heavy burdens on the people, taking forty shekels of silver from them for food and wine. Their subordinates also lorded it over the people. But I did not act this way, out of the fear of God.

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| <p>16 <i>Yea, also I continued in the work of this wall, neither bought we any land: and all my servants were gathered thither unto the work.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Moreover there were at my table an hundred and fifty of the Jews and rulers, beside those that came unto us from among the heathen that are about us.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Now that which was prepared for me daily was one ox and six choice sheep; also fowls were prepared for me, and once in ten days store of all sorts of wine: yet for all this required not I the bread of the governor, because the bondage was heavy upon this people.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Think upon me, my God, for good, according to all that I have done for this people.</i></p> | <p>I also devoted myself to the work on this wall and acquired no land. All my servants were gathered there for the work.</p> <p>Furthermore, a hundred and fifty Jews and officials ate at my table, in addition to those who came to us from the surrounding nations.</p> <p>Each day one ox, six choice sheep, and birds were prepared for me. Every ten days skins of wine of all kinds were provided. Yet I did not demand the food allotted to the governor, because the burden on these people was already heavy.</p> <p>Remember me favorably, my God, for all that I have done for this people.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v4 — Ezra 4:13
- v5 — 2 Kgs 4:1
- v7 — Lev 25:36; Deut 23:19-20; Ex 22:25
- v9 — Lev 25:36
- v12 — Ezra 10:5
- v13 — Acts 18:6
- v14 — Neh 13:6
- v15 — Neh 5:9; Prov 16:6; Isa 50:10
- v19 — Neh 13:31; Neh 13:22; Ps 106:4; Neh 13:14

Chapter 6

Sanballat, Tobiah, and Geshem tried four times to lure Nehemiah to a meeting to harm him, then hired a false prophet to frighten him into hiding in the temple. Nehemiah refused every trap, and the wall was finished in fifty-two days.

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| 1 <i>Now it came to pass, when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and Geshem the Arabian, and the rest of our enemies, heard that I had builded the wall, and that there was no breach left therein; (though at that time I had not set up the doors upon the gates;)</i> | When Sanballat, Tobiah, Geshem the Arab, and the rest of our enemies heard that I had rebuilt the wall and that there was no gap left in it — although at that time I had not yet set the doors in the gates — |
| 2 <i>That Sanballat and Geshem sent unto me, saying, Come, let us meet together in some one of the villages in the plain of Ono. But they thought to do me mischief.</i> | Sanballat and Geshem sent a message to me saying, "Come, let us meet together in one of the villages in the plain of Ono." But they intended to harm me. |
| 3 <i>And I sent messengers unto them, saying, I am doing a great work, so that I cannot come down: why should the work cease, whilst I leave it, and come down to you?</i> | So I sent messengers to them saying, "I am doing a great work and I cannot come down. Why should the work stop while I leave it and come down to you?" |
| 4 <i>Yet they sent unto me four times after this sort; and I answered them after the same manner.</i> | They sent the same message to me four times, and each time I sent the same reply. |
| 5 <i>Then sent Sanballat his servant unto me in like manner the fifth time with an open letter in his hand;</i> | Sanballat sent his servant to me in the same way a fifth time, with an open letter in his hand. |
| 6 <i>Wherein was written, It is reported among the heathen, and Gashmu saith it, that thou and the Jews think to rebel: for which cause thou buildest the wall, that thou mayest be their king, according to these words.</i> | In it was written: "It is reported among the nations — and Geshem confirms it — that you and the Jews are planning to rebel, and that is why you are building the wall. Moreover, according to these reports you intend to become their king. |

- 7 *And thou hast also appointed prophets to preach of thee at Jerusalem, saying, There is a king in Judah: and now shall it be reported to the king according to these words. Come now therefore, and let us take counsel together.* You have also appointed prophets to proclaim about you in Jerusalem, saying, 'There is a king in Judah!' Now this report will go to the king. So come, let us meet together."
- 8 *Then I sent unto him, saying, There are no such things done as thou sayest, but thou feignest them out of thine own heart.* I sent a reply saying, "Nothing of what you say has happened. You are inventing it all yourself."
- 9 *For they all made us afraid, saying, Their hands shall be weakened from the work, that it be not done. Now therefore, O God, strengthen my hands.* For they were all trying to frighten us, thinking, "Their hands will drop from the work. It will not be done." But now, O God, strengthen my hands.
- 10 *Afterward I came unto the house of Shemaiah the son of Delaiah the son of Mehetabeel, who was shut up; and he said, Let us meet together in the house of God, within the temple, and let us shut the doors of the temple: for they will come to slay thee; yea, in the night will they come to slay thee.* Then I went to the house of Shemaiah the son of Delaiah, son of Mehetabel, who was confined to his home. He said, "Let us meet together in the house of God, inside the temple, and let us close the temple doors, for they are coming to kill you — indeed, tonight they are coming to kill you."
- 11 *And I said, Should such a man as I flee? and who is there, that, being as I am, would go into the temple to save his life? I will not go in.* But I said, "Should a man like me run away? Could someone like me enter the temple to save his life? I will not go in."
- 12 *And, lo, I perceived that God had not sent him; but that he pronounced this prophecy against me: for Tobiah and Sanballat had hired him.* I realized that God had not sent him, but that He had spoken this prophecy against me because Tobiah and Sanballat had hired Him.

- 13 *Therefore was he hired, that I should be afraid, and do so, and sin, and that they might have matter for an evil report, that they might reproach me.* He was hired to frighten me, so that I would act in this way and sin. Then they could give me a bad reputation and discredit me.
- 14 *My God, think thou upon Tobiah and Sanballat according to these their works, and on the prophetess Noadiah, and the rest of the prophets, that would have put me in fear.* Remember, my God, Tobiah and Sanballat according to these deeds of theirs, and also the prophetess Noadiah and the rest of the prophets who were trying to intimidate me.
- 15 *So the wall was finished in the twenty and fifth day of the month Elul, in fifty and two days.* So the wall was completed on the twenty-fifth day of Elul, in fifty-two days.
- 16 *And it came to pass, that when all our enemies heard thereof, and all the heathen that were about us saw these things, they were much cast down in their own eyes: for they perceived that this work was wrought of our God.* When all our enemies heard of it, all the surrounding nations were afraid and fell greatly in their own estimation, for they saw that this work had been accomplished with the help of our God.
- 17 *Moreover in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters unto Tobiah, and the letters of Tobiah came unto them.* Also in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters to Tobiah, and Tobiah's letters kept coming to them.
- 18 *For there were many in Judah sworn unto him, because he was the son in law of Shechaniah the son of Arah; and his son Johanan had taken the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah.* For many in Judah were bound by oath to him, because he was the son-in-law of Shechaniah the son of Arah. His son Jehohanan had married the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah.
- 19 *Also they reported his good deeds before me, and uttered my words to him. And Tobiah sent letters to put me in fear.* They also kept telling me about his good deeds and reporting my words to him. And Tobiah sent letters to intimidate me.

Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Neh 2:10; Neh 2:19; Neh 4:1
- v2 — 1 Chr 8:12; Ps 37:12
- v3 — John 9:4; Matt 10:16; 1 Tim 4:15-16
- v6 — Neh 2:19
- v8 — Ps 52:2
- v9 — Ps 138:3; Neh 4:10-14; Eph 6:10; Phil 4:13; Heb 12:12
- v10 — Jer 36:5
- v13 — Jer 20:10
- v14 — Neh 13:29
- v16 — Josh 5:1; Ps 126:2; Neh 4:7; Neh 4:1; Neh 2:10
- v18 — Ezra 2:5

Chapter 7

After the wall was completed, Nehemiah appointed gatekeepers, singers, and Levites, and placed his brother Hanani in charge. The chapter records the genealogy of those who first returned from exile with Zerubbabel — the same register as Ezra 2.

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| <p>1 <i>Now it came to pass, when the wall was built, and I had set up the doors, and the porters and the singers and the Levites were appointed,</i></p> | <p>When the wall was rebuilt and I had set the doors in place, the gatekeepers, singers, and Levites were appointed.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>That I gave my brother Hanani, and Hananiah the ruler of the palace, charge over Jerusalem: for he was a faithful man, and feared God above many.</i></p> | <p>I put my brother Hanani in charge of Jerusalem, along with Hananiah the commander of the fortress, for he was a faithful man who feared God more than many.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And I said unto them, Let not the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun be hot; and while they stand by, let them shut the doors, and bar them: and appoint watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, every one in his watch, and every one to be over against his house.</i></p> | <p>I said to them, "The gates of Jerusalem must not be opened until the sun is hot. While the guards are still on duty, let them shut and bar the doors. Also appoint residents of Jerusalem as guards, some at their posts and some near their own homes."</p> |

- 4 *Now the city was large and great: but the people were few therein, and the houses were not builded.* Now the city was large and spacious, but the people in it were few and the houses had not yet been rebuilt.
- 5 *And my God put into mine heart to gather together the nobles, and the rulers, and the people, that they might be reckoned by genealogy. And I found a register of the genealogy of them which came up at the first, and found written therein,* My God put it into my heart to assemble the nobles, the officials, and the people to be enrolled by genealogy. I found the genealogical record of those who had come up in the first return. I found written in it:
- 6 *These are the children of the province, that went up out of the captivity, of those that had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away, and came again to Jerusalem and to Judah, every one unto his city;* These are the people of the province who came up from the captivity of the exiles whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried away, and who returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his own town:
- 7 *Who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, Baanah. The number, I say, of the men of Israel was:* They came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, and Baanah. The number of the men of Israel:
- 8 *The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.* the descendants of Parosh — 2,172;
- 9 *The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.* of Shephatiah — 372;
- 10 *The children of Arah, six hundred fifty and two.* of Arah — 652;
- 11 *The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand and eight hundred and eighteen.* of Pahath-moab, of the descendants of Jeshua and Joab — 2,818;

- 12 *The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.* of Elam — 1,254;
- 13 *The children of Zattu, eight hundred forty and five.* of Zattu — 845;
- 14 *The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.* of Zaccai — 760;
- 15 *The children of Binnui, six hundred forty and eight.* of Binnui — 648;
- 16 *The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and eight.* of Bebai — 628;
- 17 *The children of Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty and two.* of Azgad — 2,322;
- 18 *The children of Adonikam, six hundred threescore and seven.* of Adonikam — 667;
- 19 *The children of Bigvai, two thousand threescore and seven.* of Bigvai — 2,067;
- 20 *The children of Adin, six hundred fifty and five.* of Adin — 655;
- 21 *The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.* of Ater, of Hezekiah — 98;
- 22 *The children of Hashum, three hundred twenty and eight.* of Hashum — 328;
- 23 *The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and four.* of Bezai — 324;
- 24 *The children of Hariph, an hundred and twelve.* of Hariph — 112;
- 25 *The children of Gibeon, ninety and five.* of Gibeon — 95;
- 26 *The men of Bethlehem and Netophah, an hundred fourscore and eight.* the men of Bethlehem and Netophah — 188;
- 27 *The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.* of Anathoth — 128;

- 28 *The men of Bethazmaveth, forty and two.* of Beth-azmaveth — 42;
- 29 *The men of Kirjathjearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred forty and three.* of Kiriath-jearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth — 743;
- 30 *The men of Ramah and Geba, six hundred twenty and one.* of Ramah and Geba — 621;
- 31 *The men of Michmas, an hundred and twenty and two.* of Michmas — 122;
- 32 *The men of Bethel and Ai, an hundred twenty and three.* of Bethel and Ai — 123;
- 33 *The men of the other Nebo, fifty and two.* of the other Nebo — 52;
- 34 *The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.* of the other Elam — 1,254;
- 35 *The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.* of Harim — 320;
- 36 *The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.* of Jericho — 345;
- 37 *The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and one.* of Lod, Hadid, and Ono — 721;
- 38 *The children of Senaah, three thousand nine hundred and thirty.* of Senaah — 3,930.
- 39 *The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.* The priests: the descendants of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua — 973;
- 40 *The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.* of Immer — 1,052;
- 41 *The children of Pashur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.* of Pashhur — 1,247;
- 42 *The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.* of Harim — 1,017.

- 43 *The Levites: the children of Jeshua, of Kadmiel, and of the children of Hodevah, seventy and four.* The Levites: the descendants of Jeshua, of Kadmiel, of the descendants of Hodevah — 74.
- 44 *The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred forty and eight.* The singers: the descendants of Asaph — 148.
- 45 *The porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, an hundred thirty and eight.* The gatekeepers: the descendants of Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Akkub, Hatita, and Shobai — 138.
- 46 *The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hashupha, the children of Tabbaoth,* The temple servants: the descendants of Ziha, Hashupha, Tabbaoth,
- 47 *The children of Keros, the children of Sia, the children of Padon,* Keros, Sia, Padon,
- 48 *The children of Lebana, the children of Hagaba, the children of Shalmal,* Lebana, Hagaba, Shalmal,
- 49 *The children of Hanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Gahar,* Hanan, Giddel, Gahar,
- 50 *The children of Reaiah, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda,* Reaiah, Rezin, Nekoda,
- 51 *The children of Gazzam, the children of Uzza, the children of Phaseah,* Gazzam, Uzza, Paseah,
- 52 *The children of Besai, the children of Meunim, the children of Nephishesim,* Besai, Meunim, Nephushesim,
- 53 *The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,* Bakbuk, Hakupha, Harhur,
- 54 *The children of Bazlith, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha,* Bazlith, Mehida, Harsha,
- 55 *The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Tamah,* Barkos, Sisera, Temah,
- 56 *The children of Nezhiah, the children of Hatipha.* Nezhiah, and Hatipha.

- 57 *The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida,* The descendants of Solomon's servants: the descendants of Sotai, Sophereth, Perida,
- 58 *The children of Jaala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,* Jaala, Darkon, Giddel,
- 59 *The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Amon.* Shephatiah, Hattil, Pochereth-hazzebaim, and Amon.
- 60 *All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.* All the temple servants and the descendants of Solomon's servants were 392.
- 61 *And these were they which went up also from Telmelah, Telharsesha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, nor their seed, whether they were of Israel.* The following came up from Tel-melah, Tel-harsha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer. But they could not prove their ancestral houses or their descent, whether they were from Israel:
- 62 *The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred forty and two.* the descendants of Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda — 642.
- 63 *And of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai, which took one of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite to wife, and was called after their name.* among the priests: the descendants of Hobaiah, Hakkoz, and Barzillai (who had married a daughter of Barzillai the Gileadite and was called by their name).
- 64 *These sought their register among those that were reckoned by genealogy, but it was not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.* These searched for their entries in the genealogical records. But they could not be found. They were excluded from the priesthood as unclean.

- 65 *And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with Urim and Thummim.* The governor told them that they should not eat any of the most holy food until there was a priest serving with Urim and Thummim.
- 66 *The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,* The whole assembly together numbered 42,360,
- 67 *Beside their manservants and their maidservants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and they had two hundred forty and five singing men and singing women.* besides their male and female servants, who numbered 7,337. They also had 245 male and female singers.
- 68 *Their horses, seven hundred thirty and six: their mules, two hundred forty and five:* Their horses numbered 736, their mules 245,
- 69 *Their camels, four hundred thirty and five: six thousand seven hundred and twenty asses.* their camels 435. Their donkeys 6,720.
- 70 *And some of the chief of the fathers gave unto the work. The Tirshatha gave to the treasury a thousand drams of gold, fifty basons, five hundred and thirty priests' garments.* Some of the heads of families contributed to the work. The governor gave to the treasury 1,000 gold coins, 50 bowls, and 530 priestly garments.
- 71 *And some of the chief of the fathers gave to the treasure of the work twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand and two hundred pound of silver.* Some of the heads of families gave to the treasury for the work 20,000 gold coins and 2,200 pounds of silver.
- 72 *And that which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand pound of silver, and threescore and seven priests' garments.* The rest of the people gave 20,000 gold coins, 2,000 pounds of silver, and 67 priestly garments.

- 73 *So the priests, and the Levites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Nethinims, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities; and when the seventh month came, the children of Israel were in their cities.* The priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers, the temple servants, and all Israel settled in their towns. When the seventh month came, the people of Israel were in their towns.

Words in this chapter:

Thummim (*THUM-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate alongside the Urim — together they were God's tool for giving yes/no answers to Israel's leaders.

Urim (*YOOR-im*) — One of two sacred objects kept in the high priest's breastplate — used to seek God's guidance on important decisions; its exact form is unknown.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Tirshatha (*ter-SHAY-thah*) — The Persian title given to Nehemiah (and to Zerubbabel in Ezra 2:63) — a title meaning 'governor' or 'his excellency'; used in the books of Ezra and Nehemiah.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ps 101:6; Neh 1:2; Matt 25:21

v6 — Ezra 2:1-70; Ezra 5:8

v7 — Ezra 2:2

v61 — Ezra 2:59

v65 — Ex 28:30; Neh 8:9

Chapter 8

Ezra read the Book of the Law aloud to all the people from morning until midday at the Water Gate, and the Levites helped the people understand it. The people wept when they heard the law, but Nehemiah told them to rejoice; they then celebrated the Feast of Tabernacles.

- 1 *And all the people gathered themselves together as one man into the street that was before the water gate; and they spake unto Ezra the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.*

All the people gathered together as one in the square before the Water Gate. They told Ezra the scribe to bring out the Book of the Law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded for Israel.
- 2 *And Ezra the priest brought the law before the congregation both of men and women, and all that could hear with understanding, upon the first day of the seventh month.*

So Ezra the priest brought the Law before the assembly — both men and women and all who could understand — on the first day of the seventh month.
- 3 *And he read therein before the street that was before the water gate from the morning until midday, before the men and the women, and those that could understand; and the ears of all the people were attentive unto the book of the law.*

He read from it in the square before the Water Gate from early morning until midday, in the presence of the men, the women, and those who could understand. All the people listened attentively to the Book of the Law.
- 4 *And Ezra the scribe stood upon a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose; and beside him stood Mattithiah, and Shema, and Anaiah, and Urijah, and Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand; and on his left hand, Pedaiah, and Mishael, and Malchiah, and Hashum, and Hashbadana, Zechariah, and Meshullam.*

Ezra the scribe stood on a high wooden platform that had been made for the occasion. Standing beside him on his right were Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, and on his left were Pedaiah, Mishael, Malchijah, Hashum, Hashbaddanah, Zechariah, and Meshullam.
- 5 *And Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people; (for he was above all the people;) and when he opened it, all the people stood up:*

Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people, for he was standing above them. When he opened it, all the people stood up.

- 6 *And Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God. And all the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting up their hands: and they bowed their heads, and worshipped the LORD with their faces to the ground.* Ezra praised the LORD, the great God. All the people answered, "Amen, Amen!" lifting up their hands. Then they bowed down and worshiped the LORD with their faces to the ground.
- 7 *Also Jeshua, and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodijah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the Levites, caused the people to understand the law: and the people stood in their place.* Jeshua, Bani, Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodijah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, and Pelaiah — the Levites — helped the people understand the Law while the people stood in their places.
- 8 *So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading.* They read from the Book of the Law of God, translating and explaining it so that the people could understand what was being read.
- 9 *And Nehemiah, which is the Tirshatha, and Ezra the priest scribe, and the Levites that taught the people, said unto all the people, This day is holy unto the LORD your God; mourn not, nor weep. For all the people wept, when they heard the words of the law.* Then Nehemiah the governor, Ezra the priest and scribe, and the Levites who were teaching the people said to all the people, "This day is holy to the LORD Your God. Do not mourn or weep." For all the people had been weeping as they listened to the words of the Law.
- 10 *Then he said unto them, Go your way, eat the fat, and drink the sweet, and send portions unto them for whom nothing is prepared: for this day is holy unto our LORD: neither be ye sorry; for the joy of the LORD is your strength.* Nehemiah said to them, "Go, eat rich food and drink sweet drinks, and send portions to those for whom nothing is prepared, for this day is holy to our Lord. Do not grieve, for the joy of the LORD is Your strength."
- 11 *So the Levites stilled all the people, saying, Hold your peace, for the day is holy; neither be ye grieved.* The Levites quieted all the people, saying, "Be still, for this day is holy; do not grieve."

- 12 *And all the people went their way to eat, and to drink, and to send portions, and to make great mirth, because they had understood the words that were declared unto them.* Then all the people went away to eat and drink, to send portions and celebrate with great joy, because they now understood the words that had been made known to them.
- 13 *And on the second day were gathered together the chief of the fathers of all the people, the priests, and the Levites, unto Ezra the scribe, even to understand the words of the law.* On the second day the heads of families of all the people, together with the priests and the Levites, gathered around Ezra the scribe to study the words of the Law.
- 14 *And they found written in the law which the LORD had commanded by Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month:* They found written in the Law that the LORD had commanded through Moses that the people of Israel should live in shelters during the feast of the seventh month,
- 15 *And that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying, Go forth unto the mount, and fetch olive branches, and pine branches, and myrtle branches, and palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make booths, as it is written.* that they should proclaim in all their towns and in Jerusalem, "Go out to the hill country and bring back branches of olive, wild olive, myrtle, palm, and other leafy trees to make shelters," as it is written.
- 16 *So the people went forth, and brought them, and made themselves booths, every one upon the roof of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the street of the water gate, and in the street of the gate of Ephraim.* So the people went out and brought branches and built shelters for themselves — each on His rooftop, in His courtyard, in the courts of the house of God, in the square at the Water Gate, and in the square at the Gate of Ephraim.

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| <p>17 <i>And all the congregation of them that were come again out of the captivity made booths, and sat under the booths: for since the days of Jeshua the son of Nun unto that day had not the children of Israel done so. And there was very great gladness.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Also day by day, from the first day unto the last day, he read in the book of the law of God. And they kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day was a solemn assembly, according unto the manner.</i></p> | <p>The whole assembly of those who had returned from exile built shelters and lived in them. The people of Israel had not done this from the days of Joshua the son of Nun until that day. And there was very great rejoicing.</p> <p>Day after day, from the first day to the last, Ezra read from the Book of the Law of God. They celebrated the feast for seven days, and on the eighth day held a solemn assembly, according to the rule.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ezra (*EZ-rah*) — A priest and scribe who led a group of exiles back from Babylon — restored the Law among the returned community; his name means 'help.'

Joshua (*JOSH-oo-ah*) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezra 7:6; 2 Chr 34:15; Neh 3:26
- v2 — Lev 23:24
- v5 — Judg 3:20
- v6 — 1 Tim 2:8; Lam 3:41; Ex 4:31; 2 Chr 20:18; Rev 7:11
- v7 — Neh 9:4; Lev 10:11
- v8 — Luke 24:45; Acts 28:23; Acts 8:30-35; Hab 2:2; Luke 24:27
- v9 — Neh 7:70; Deut 12:12; Neh 7:65
- v10 — Ps 28:7-8; Prov 17:22; 2 Cor 12:8-9; Eccl 9:7; Isa 12:1-3
- v12 — Ps 119:174
- v14 — Lev 23:34; Deut 16:13-15; Lev 23:40-43; Zech 14:16-19
- v16 — 2 Kgs 14:13; Neh 12:39
- v18 — Lev 23:36; Num 29:35

Chapter 9

The Israelites assembled in fasting and sackcloth and confessed their sins. The Levites led a long prayer recounting God's faithfulness from Abraham through the exodus, the wilderness, the conquest, the judges, and the exile, acknowledging that God was just in all that had come upon them.

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| <p>1 <i>Now in the twenty and fourth day of this month the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, and with sackclothes, and earth upon them.</i></p> | <p>On the twenty-fourth day of the same month, the people of Israel assembled with fasting, in sackcloth, and with dirt on their heads.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the seed of Israel separated themselves from all strangers, and stood and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers.</i></p> | <p>Those of Israelite descent separated themselves from all foreigners. They stood and confessed their sins and the iniquities of their ancestors.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they stood up in their place, and read in the book of the law of the LORD their God one fourth part of the day; and another fourth part they confessed, and worshipped the LORD their God.</i></p> | <p>They stood where they were and read from the Book of the Law of the LORD their God for a quarter of the day, and spent another quarter confessing and worshipping the LORD their God.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then stood up upon the stairs, of the Levites, Jeshua, and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani, and cried with a loud voice unto the LORD their God.</i></p> | <p>Standing on the Levites' platform were Jeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani. They cried out with a loud voice to the LORD their God.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Then the Levites, Jeshua, and Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodijah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, said, Stand up and bless the LORD your God for ever and ever: and blessed be thy glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.</i></p> | <p>The Levites — Jeshua, Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodijah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah — said, "Stand up and bless the LORD Your God from everlasting to everlasting. Blessed be Your glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Thou, even thou, art LORD alone; thou hast made heaven, the heaven of heavens, with all their host, the earth, and all things that are therein, the seas, and all that is therein, and thou preservest them all; and the host of heaven worshippeth thee.</i></p> | <p>You are the LORD, You alone. You have made heaven, the heaven of heavens, with all their host, the earth and all that is on it, the seas and all that is in them. You preserve all of them. The host of heaven worships You.</p> |

- 7 *Thou art the LORD the God, who didst choose Abram, and broughtest him forth out of Ur of the Chaldees, and gavest him the name of Abraham;* You are the LORD God, Who chose Abram and brought him out of Ur of the Chaldeans and gave Him the name Abraham.
- 8 *And foundest his heart faithful before thee, and madest a covenant with him to give the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Jebusites, and the Girgashites, to give it, I say, to his seed, and hast performed thy words; for thou art righteous:* You found His heart faithful before You and made a covenant with Him to give the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, and the Girgashites — to give it to His descendants. You have kept Your promise, for You are righteous.
- 9 *And didst see the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and heardest their cry by the Red sea;* You saw the affliction of our ancestors in Egypt and heard their cry by the Red Sea.
- 10 *And shewedst signs and wonders upon Pharaoh, and on all his servants, and on all the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them. So didst thou get thee a name, as it is this day.* You performed signs and wonders against Pharaoh, against all his servants, and against all the people of his land, for you knew how arrogantly they treated our ancestors. You made a name for yourself that endures to this day.
- 11 *And thou didst divide the sea before them, so that they went through the midst of the sea on the dry land; and their persecutors thou threwest into the deeps, as a stone into the mighty waters.* You divided the sea before them, so they passed through it on dry ground. But their pursuers you hurled into the depths, like a stone into mighty waters.
- 12 *Moreover thou leddest them in the day by a cloudy pillar; and in the night by a pillar of fire, to give them light in the way wherein they should go.* You led them with a pillar of cloud by day and a pillar of fire by night to light the way they were to take.

- 13 *Thou camest down also upon mount Sinai, and spakest with them from heaven, and gavest them right judgments, and true laws, good statutes and commandments:* You came down on Mount Sinai and spoke with them from heaven. You gave them right judgments and true laws, good statutes and commandments.
- 14 *And madest known unto them thy holy sabbath, and commandedst them precepts, statutes, and laws, by the hand of Moses thy servant:* You made known to them your holy Sabbath and gave them commandments, statutes, and a law through your servant Moses.
- 15 *And gavest them bread from heaven for their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rock for their thirst, and promisedst them that they should go in to possess the land which thou hadst sworn to give them.* You gave them bread from heaven for their hunger and brought forth water from the rock for their thirst. You told them to go in and possess the land you had sworn with your hand to give them.
- 16 *But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks, and hearkened not to thy commandments,* But they and our ancestors acted arrogantly. They became stubborn and did not obey your commandments.
- 17 *And refused to obey, neither were mindful of thy wonders that thou didst among them; but hardened their necks, and in their rebellion appointed a captain to return to their bondage: but thou art a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and forsookest them not.* They refused to listen and did not remember the wonders you performed among them. They stiffened their necks and in their rebellion appointed a leader to return to slavery. But you are a God ready to forgive, gracious and merciful, longsuffering and of great kindness, and you did not abandon them.
- 18 *Yea, when they had made them a molten calf, and said, This is thy God that brought thee up out of Egypt, and had wrought great provocations;* Even when they made for themselves a golden calf and said, 'This is your God Who brought you up out of Egypt,' and committed great blasphemies,

- 19 *Yet thou in thy manifold mercies forsookest them not in the wilderness: the pillar of the cloud departed not from them by day, to lead them in the way; neither the pillar of fire by night, to shew them light, and the way wherein they should go.* Yet you in your great mercy did not abandon them in the wilderness. The pillar of cloud did not stop leading them by day, nor the pillar of fire by night to light their way.
- 20 *Thou gavest also thy good spirit to instruct them, and withheldest not thy manna from their mouth, and gavest them water for their thirst.* You gave your good Spirit to instruct them. You did not withhold your manna from their mouths, and you gave them water when they were thirsty.
- 21 *Yea, forty years didst thou sustain them in the wilderness, so that they lacked nothing; their clothes waxed not old, and their feet swelled not.* For forty years you sustained them in the wilderness. They lacked nothing; their clothes did not wear out and their feet did not swell.
- 22 *Moreover thou gavest them kingdoms and nations, and didst divide them into corners: so they possessed the land of Sihon, and the land of the king of Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan.* You gave them kingdoms and peoples and divided the lands among them. They took possession of the land of Sihon king of Heshbon and the land of Og king of Bashan.
- 23 *Their children also multipliedst thou as the stars of heaven, and broughtest them into the land, concerning which thou hadst promised to their fathers, that they should go in to possess it.* You multiplied their descendants like the stars of heaven and brought them into the land you had told their ancestors to enter and possess.
- 24 *So the children went in and possessed the land, and thou subduedst before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gavest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might do with them as they would.* So their descendants went in and possessed the land. You subdued the Canaanites before them and handed their kings and the peoples of the land over to them, to do with as they pleased.

- 25 *And they took strong cities, and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods, wells digged, vineyards, and oliveyards, and fruit trees in abundance: so they did eat, and were filled, and became fat, and delighted themselves in thy great goodness.* They captured fortified cities and fertile land. They took possession of houses full of all good things, cisterns already dug, vineyards, olive groves, and fruit trees in abundance. They ate and were satisfied and became well-fed and lived in luxury in your great goodness.
- 26 *Nevertheless they were disobedient, and rebelled against thee, and cast thy law behind their backs, and slew thy prophets which testified against them to turn them to thee, and they wrought great provocations.* But they were disobedient and rebelled against you. They threw your law behind their backs and killed your prophets who had warned them to return to you. They committed terrible blasphemies.
- 27 *Therefore thou deliveredst them into the hand of their enemies, who vexed them: and in the time of their trouble, when they cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and according to thy manifold mercies thou gavest them saviours, who saved them out of the hand of their enemies.* So you handed them over to their enemies, who oppressed them. But when they cried out to you in the time of their suffering, you heard from heaven, and according to your great mercy you gave them deliverers who rescued them from the hands of their enemies.
- 28 *But after they had rest, they did evil again before thee: therefore leftest thou them in the hand of their enemies, so that they had the dominion over them: yet when they returned, and cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and many times didst thou deliver them according to thy mercies;* But as soon as they had relief, they did evil again before you. So you abandoned them to the hand of their enemies. They ruled over them. Then when they cried out to you again, you heard from heaven and delivered them many times in your mercy.

- 29 *And testifiedst against them, that thou mightest bring them again unto thy law: yet they dealt proudly, and hearkened not unto thy commandments, but sinned against thy judgments, (which if a man do, he shall live in them;) and withdrew the shoulder, and hardened their neck, and would not hear.* You warned them to return to your law. But they acted arrogantly and did not obey your commandments. They sinned against your ordinances — by which a person will live if he does them. They stubbornly turned their backs, stiffened their necks, and would not listen.
- 30 *Yet many years didst thou forbear them, and testifiedst against them by thy spirit in thy prophets: yet would they not give ear: therefore gavest thou them into the hand of the people of the lands.* For many years you bore with them. You warned them by your Spirit through your prophets, yet they would not listen. So you handed them over to the peoples of the surrounding lands.
- 31 *Nevertheless for thy great mercies' sake thou didst not utterly consume them, nor forsake them; for thou art a gracious and merciful God.* Yet in your great mercy you did not utterly destroy them or abandon them, for you are a gracious and merciful God.
- 32 *Now therefore, our God, the great, the mighty, and the terrible God, who keepest covenant and mercy, let not all the trouble seem little before thee, that hath come upon us, on our kings, on our princes, and on our priests, and on our prophets, and on our fathers, and on all thy people, since the time of the kings of Assyria unto this day.* Now therefore, our God — the great, the mighty, and the awesome God, Who keeps covenant and mercy — do not let all the hardship seem small to you that has come upon us: our kings, our officials, our priests, our prophets, our ancestors. All your people, from the days of the kings of Assyria to this day.
- 33 *Howbeit thou art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly:* You have been righteous in all that has come upon us, for you have acted faithfully and we have acted wickedly.

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| <p>34 <i>Neither have our kings, our princes, our priests, nor our fathers, kept thy law, nor hearkened unto thy commandments and thy testimonies, wherewith thou didst testify against them.</i></p> | <p>Our kings, our officials, our priests, and our ancestors have not kept your law or paid attention to your commandments and warnings you gave them.</p> |
| <p>35 <i>For they have not served thee in their kingdom, and in thy great goodness that thou gavest them, and in the large and fat land which thou gavest before them, neither turned they from their wicked works.</i></p> | <p>Even in their own kingdom, despite all your great goodness toward them and despite the broad and fertile land you gave them, they did not serve you and did not turn from their wicked ways.</p> |
| <p>36 <i>Behold, we are servants this day, and for the land that thou gavest unto our fathers to eat the fruit thereof and the good thereof, behold, we are servants in it:</i></p> | <p>See, we are slaves today — slaves in the land you gave to our ancestors so they could eat its fruit and its good gifts.</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And it yieldeth much increase unto the kings whom thou hast set over us because of our sins: also they have dominion over our bodies, and over our cattle, at their pleasure, and we are in great distress.</i></p> | <p>Its abundant produce goes to the kings you have placed over us because of our sins. They rule over our bodies and over our livestock as they please. We are in great distress.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And because of all this we make a sure covenant, and write it; and our princes, Levites, and priests, seal unto it.</i></p> | <p>Because of all this we are making a firm covenant in writing, and our officials, Levites, and priests are putting their seals on it."</p> |

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Amorites (*AM-oh-rytes*) — A major Canaanite people group — their two kings Sihon and Og were defeated by Israel east of the Jordan; their name may mean 'westerners' or 'highlanders.'

- Canaanites** (*KAY-nan-ytes*) — The original inhabitants of the Promised Land — descendants of Ham's son Canaan; Israel was commanded to drive them out because of their wickedness.
- Girgashites** (*GER-gah-shytes*) — One of the seven Canaanite nations — listed among the peoples that Israel displaced; little else is known about them beyond their name.
- Hittites** (*HIT-ytes*) — A Canaanite people group (distinct from the Hittite Empire) — Abraham bought the cave of Machpelah from a Hittite; Uriah, one of David's warriors, was a Hittite.
- Jebusites** (*JEB-yoo-zytes*) — The original inhabitants of Jerusalem (called Jebus) — David captured their stronghold and made Jerusalem his capital; his name comes from 'Jebus.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Neh 13:3; Dan 9:3-10; Ezra 10:11; Neh 13:30; Dan 9:20
- v6 — Isa 37:16; Gen 1:1; Rev 4:11; Deut 10:14; Deut 6:4
- v13 — Ps 119:160; Ex 20:1; Ex 19:11; Ps 119:127-128
- v15 — 1 Cor 10:3-4; Deut 1:8; Ex 17:6; Ex 16:4; Ex 16:14-15
- v17 — Ps 86:5; Joel 2:13; Ps 86:15; Ps 145:8-9; Mic 7:18-19
- v19 — Neh 9:27; Ps 106:45; Neh 9:12; Mal 3:6
- v20 — Ps 143:10; Num 11:17; Isa 63:11-14; 2 Pet 1:21; John 4:10
- v21 — Deut 2:7; Deut 8:4; Deut 29:5; Ps 34:10
- v29 — Neh 9:16; Lev 18:5; Neh 9:10; Neh 9:26
- v30 — Rom 2:4; 2 Chr 36:15-16; Isa 63:10; Isa 42:24; Acts 7:51
- v31 — Lam 3:22; Neh 9:17; Ex 34:6-7; Ps 103:8-9; Jer 4:27
- v38 — Neh 10:1; 2 Chr 34:31; Ezra 10:3; Neh 10:29

Chapter 10

The leaders, Levites, and priests sealed a written covenant, and the people bound themselves by oath to walk in God’s law. They pledged not to intermarry with surrounding peoples, to keep the Sabbath, to support the temple with the yearly third-of-a-shekel tax, and to bring their tithes and firstfruits.

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| 1 | <i>Now those that sealed were,</i> | Those who sealed it were: Nehemiah |
| | <i>Nehemiah, the Tirshatha, the son of</i> | the governor, son of Hachaliah, and |
| | <i>Hachaliah, and Zidkijah,</i> | Zedekiah, |
| 2 | <i>Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,</i> | Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah, |
| 3 | <i>Pashur, Amariah, Malchijah,</i> | Pashhur, Amariah, Malchijah, |
| 4 | <i>Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,</i> | Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch, |
| 5 | <i>Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,</i> | Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah, |
| 6 | <i>Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,</i> | Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch, |

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| <p>7 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,</p> <p>8 Maaziah, Bilgai, Shemaiah: these were the priests.</p> <p>9 And the Levites: both Jeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;</p> <p>10 And their brethren, Shebaniah, Hodijah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,</p> <p>11 Micha, Rehob, Hashabiah,</p> <p>12 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,</p> <p>13 Hodijah, Bani, Beninu.</p> <p>14 The chief of the people; Parosh, Pahathmoab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,</p> <p>15 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,</p> <p>16 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,</p> <p>17 Ater, Hizkijah, Azzur,</p> <p>18 Hodijah, Hashum, Bezai,</p> <p>19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,</p> <p>20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,</p> <p>21 Meshezabeel, Zadok, Jaddua,</p> <p>22 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,</p> <p>23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hashub,</p> <p>24 Hallohes, Pileha, Shobek,</p> <p>25 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,</p> <p>26 And Ahijah, Hanan, Anan,</p> <p>27 Malluch, Harim, Baanah.</p> | <p>Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,</p> <p>Maaziah, Bilgai, and Shemaiah. These were the priests.</p> <p>The Levites: Jeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;</p> <p>their brothers: Shebaniah, Hodijah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,</p> <p>Mica, Rehob, Hashabiah,</p> <p>Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,</p> <p>Hodijah, Bani, and Beninu.</p> <p>The leaders of the people: Parosh, Pahath-moab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,</p> <p>Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,</p> <p>Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,</p> <p>Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur,</p> <p>Hodijah, Hashum, Bezai,</p> <p>Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,</p> <p>Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,</p> <p>Meshezabeel, Zadok, Jaddua,</p> <p>Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,</p> <p>Hoshea, Hananiah, Hasshub,</p> <p>Hallohes, Pileha, Shobek,</p> <p>Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,</p> <p>Ahijah, Hanan, Anan,</p> <p>Malluch, Harim, and Baanah.</p> |
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- 28 *And the rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the porters, the singers, the Nethinims, and all they that had separated themselves from the people of the lands unto the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, every one having knowledge, and having understanding;* The rest of the people — the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers, the temple servants, and all who had separated themselves from the peoples of the lands to the Law of God, together with their wives, sons, and daughters, all who had knowledge and understanding —
- 29 *They clave to their brethren, their nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our LORD, and his judgments and his statutes;* joined their brothers, their nobles, and bound themselves with a curse and an oath to walk in God's Law, which was given through Moses the servant of God, and to observe and keep all the commandments of the LORD our Lord, and His ordinances and statutes.
- 30 *And that we would not give our daughters unto the people of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons:* We would not give our daughters to the peoples of the land or take their daughters for our sons.
- 31 *And if the people of the land bring ware or any victuals on the sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy it of them on the sabbath, or on the holy day: and that we would leave the seventh year, and the exaction of every debt.* If the peoples of the land bring goods or any grain to sell on the Sabbath, we would not buy from them on the Sabbath or on any holy day. We would forego the produce of the seventh year and the cancellation of every debt.
- 32 *Also we made ordinances for us, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel for the service of the house of God;* We also took on the obligation to give a third of a shekel each year for the service of the house of God:

- 33 *For the shewbread, and for the continual meat offering, and for the continual burnt offering, of the sabbaths, of the new moons, for the set feasts, and for the holy things, and for the sin offerings to make an atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of God.* for the bread of the Presence, the regular grain offering, the regular burnt offering, the Sabbaths, the new moons, the appointed festivals, the holy things, the sin offerings to make atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of God.
- 34 *And we cast the lots among the priests, the Levites, and the people, for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, after the houses of our fathers, at times appointed year by year, to burn upon the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the law:* We also cast lots among the priests, the Levites, and the people for the wood offering, to bring it to the house of our God by our ancestral houses at appointed times each year, to burn on the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the Law.
- 35 *And to bring the firstfruits of our ground, and the firstfruits of all fruit of all trees, year by year, unto the house of the LORD:* We obligated ourselves to bring the firstfruits of our ground and the firstfruits of every fruit tree year by year to the house of the LORD,
- 36 *Also the firstborn of our sons, and of our cattle, as it is written in the law, and the firstlings of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, unto the priests that minister in the house of our God:* to bring to the house of our God, to the priests who minister there, the firstborn of our sons and of our cattle, as written in the Law, and the firstborn of our herds and our flocks.
- 37 *And that we should bring the firstfruits of our dough, and our offerings, and the fruit of all manner of trees, of wine and of oil, unto the priests, to the chambers of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground unto the Levites, that the same Levites might have the tithes in all the cities of our tillage.* We would also bring to the priests in the storerooms of the house of our God the first of our dough, our contributions, the fruit of every tree, wine, and oil. And we would bring the tithe of our ground to the Levites, for it is the Levites who collect the tithes in all our agricultural towns.

- 38 *And the priest the son of Aaron shall be with the Levites, when the Levites take tithes: and the Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes unto the house of our God, to the chambers, into the treasure house.* The priest, a son of Aaron, shall accompany the Levites when they receive the tithes, and the Levites shall bring up a tithe of the tithes to the house of our God, to the storerooms of the treasury.
- 39 *For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the offering of the corn, of the new wine, and the oil, unto the chambers, where are the vessels of the sanctuary, and the priests that minister, and the porters, and the singers: and we will not forsake the house of our God.* For the people of Israel and the descendants of Levi shall bring the contribution of grain, new wine, and oil to the storerooms where the vessels of the sanctuary are kept, where the ministering priests, the gatekeepers, and the singers are. We will not neglect the house of our God.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

vituals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

v28 — Neh 9:2

v29 — Ezek 36:27; Ps 119:106

v30 — Deut 7:3; Ex 34:16; Ezra 9:1-3

v31 — Lev 23:3; Neh 13:15-22; Ex 23:10-11

v33 — 2 Chr 2:4

v34 — Neh 13:31

v35 — Deut 26:2; Ex 23:19

v36 — Ex 13:2

v37 — Lev 23:17

v38 — Neh 13:12-13; Num 18:26-28

v39 — 2 Chr 31:12

Chapter 11

The leaders lived in Jerusalem, and one out of every ten people was chosen by lot to settle in the holy city. The chapter lists the heads of families from Judah and Benjamin, the priests, and the Levites who dwelt in Jerusalem and the surrounding towns.

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| <p>1 <i>And the rulers of the people dwelt at Jerusalem: the rest of the people also cast lots, to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem the holy city, and nine parts to dwell in other cities.</i></p> | <p>The leaders of the people settled in Jerusalem. The rest of the people cast lots to bring one in ten to live in Jerusalem, the holy city, while the other nine tenths remained in the other towns.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the people blessed all the men, that willingly offered themselves to dwell at Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>The people blessed all the men who volunteered to live in Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now these are the chief of the province that dwelt in Jerusalem: but in the cities of Judah dwelt every one in his possession in their cities, to wit, Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants.</i></p> | <p>These are the leaders of the province who settled in Jerusalem. (But in the towns of Judah, everyone lived on his own property in their towns — Israel, the priests, the Levites, the temple servants, and the descendants of Solomon's servants.)</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And at Jerusalem dwelt certain of the children of Judah, and of the children of Benjamin. Of the children of Judah; Athaiah the son of Uzziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalaleel, of the children of Perez;</i></p> | <p>Some of the people of Judah and some of the people of Benjamin settled in Jerusalem. From the descendants of Judah: Athaiah the son of Uzziah, son of Zechariah, son of Amariah, son of Shephatiah, son of Mahalaleel, of the descendants of Perez;</p> |

- 5 *And Maaseiah the son of Baruch, the son of Colhozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the son of Shiloni.* Maaseiah the son of Baruch, son of Col-hozeh, son of Hazaiah, son of Adaiah, son of Joiarib, son of Zechariah, son of Shiloni.
- 6 *All the sons of Perez that dwelt at Jerusalem were four hundred threescore and eight valiant men.* All the descendants of Perez who settled in Jerusalem were 468 capable men.
- 7 *And these are the sons of Benjamin; Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jesaiah.* From the descendants of Benjamin: Sallu the son of Meshullam, son of Joed, son of Pedaiah, son of Kolaiah, son of Maaseiah, son of Ithiel, son of Jeshiah.
- 8 *And after him Gabbai, Sallai, nine hundred twenty and eight.* after him Gabbai and Sallai — 928.
- 9 *And Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer: and Judah the son of Senuah was second over the city.* Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer, and Judah the son of Hassenuah was second in charge of the city.
- 10 *Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin.* From the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin,
- 11 *Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, was the ruler of the house of God.* Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, son of Meshullam, son of Zadok, son of Meraioth, son of Ahitub — the officer in charge of the house of God,
- 12 *And their brethren that did the work of the house were eight hundred twenty and two: and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashur, the son of Malchijah,* their brothers who did the work of the temple — 822. Adaiah the son of Jeroham, son of Pelaliah, son of Amzi, son of Zechariah, son of Pashhur, son of Malchijah,

- 13 *And his brethren, chief of the fathers, two hundred forty and two: and Amashai the son of Azareel, the son of Ahasai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,* his brothers, heads of families — 242. Amashai the son of Azareel, son of Ahasai, son of Meshillemoth, son of Immer,
- 14 *And their brethren, mighty men of valour, an hundred twenty and eight: and their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of one of the great men.* their brothers, men of great ability — 128. Their overseer was Zabdiel the son of one of the great men.
- 15 *Also of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;* From the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, son of Azrikam, son of Hashabiah, son of Bunni;
- 16 *And Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the chief of the Levites, had the oversight of the outward business of the house of God.* Shabbethai and Jozabad, from the heads of the Levites, who were in charge of the outside work of the house of God;
- 17 *And Mattaniah the son of Micha, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, was the principal to begin the thanksgiving in prayer: and Bakbukiah the second among his brethren, and Abda the son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun.* Mattaniah the son of Mica, son of Zabdi, son of Asaph, who was the leader of the opening of prayer and thanksgiving, and Bakbukiah, second among his brothers. Abda the son of Shammua, son of Galal, son of Jeduthun.
- 18 *All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred fourscore and four.* All the Levites in the holy city were 284.
- 19 *Moreover the porters, Akkub, Talmon, and their brethren that kept the gates, were an hundred seventy and two.* The gatekeepers — Akkub, Talmon, and their brothers who kept watch at the gates — were 172.
- 20 *And the residue of Israel, of the priests, and the Levites, were in all the cities of Judah, every one in his inheritance.* The rest of Israel — priests and Levites — were in all the towns of Judah, each on his own inherited property.

- 21 *But the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel: and Ziha and Gispa were over the Nethinims.* The temple servants lived on the hill of Ophel, and Ziha and Gishpa were over the temple servants.
- 22 *The overseer also of the Levites at Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micha. Of the sons of Asaph, the singers were over the business of the house of God.* The overseer of the Levites in Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, son of Hashabiah, son of Mattaniah, son of Mica, from the descendants of Asaph. The singers were responsible for the service of the house of God.
- 23 *For it was the king's commandment concerning them, that a certain portion should be for the singers, due for every day.* For there was a royal command concerning them, and a fixed provision for the singers each day.
- 24 *And Pethahiah the son of Meshezabeel, of the children of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's hand in all matters concerning the people.* Pethahiah the son of Meshezabel, of the descendants of Zerah the son of Judah, was the king's agent in all matters concerning the people.
- 25 *And for the villages, with their fields, some of the children of Judah dwelt at Kirjatharba, and in the villages thereof, and at Dibon, and in the villages thereof, and at Jekabzeel, and in the villages thereof,* As for the villages with their fields: some of the people of Judah lived in Kiriath-arba and its villages, in Dibon and its villages, in Jekabzeel and its villages,
- 26 *And at Jeshua, and at Moladah, and at Bethphelet,* in Jeshua, Moladah, Beth-pelet,
- 27 *And at Hazarshual, and at Beersheba, and in the villages thereof,* Hazar-shual, Beersheba and its villages,
- 28 *And at Ziklag, and at Mekonah, and in the villages thereof,* Ziklag, Meconah and its villages,
- 29 *And at Enrimmon, and at Zareah, and at Jarmuth,* En-rimmon, Zareah, Jarmuth,

30	<i>Zanoah, Adullam, and in their villages, at Lachish, and the fields thereof, at Azekah, and in the villages thereof. And they dwelt from Beersheba unto the valley of Hinnom.</i>	Zanoah, Adullam. Their villages, Lachish and its fields, and Azekah and its villages. They settled from Beersheba to the Valley of Hinnom.
31	<i>The children also of Benjamin from Geba dwelt at Michmash, and Aija, and Bethel, and in their villages,</i>	The descendants of Benjamin from Geba settled in Michmash, Aija, Bethel and its villages,
32	<i>And at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah,</i>	Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah,
33	<i>Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,</i>	Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,
34	<i>Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,</i>	Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,
35	<i>Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen.</i>	Lod, and Ono — the Valley of Craftsmen.
36	<i>And of the Levites were divisions in Judah, and in Benjamin.</i>	Some divisions of the Levites in Judah were assigned to Benjamin.

Words in this chapter:

Jeduthun (*jeh-DOO-thun*) — A musical director in David's time — Psalm titles addressed 'to' or 'after' him indicate his musical style.

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 48:2; Isa 52:1
- v2 — Judg 5:9
- v21 — Neh 3:26
- v25 — Josh 14:15

Chapter 12

The chapter records the priests and Levites who returned with Zerubbabel and those who served in subsequent generations. At the dedication of the wall, two great processions marched in opposite directions on top of the wall and met at the temple with singing and sacrifices of great joy.

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| <p>1 <i>Now these are the priests and the Levites that went up with Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,</i></p> <p>3 <i>Shechaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,</i></p> <p>4 <i>Iddo, Ginnetho, Abijah,</i></p> <p>5 <i>Miamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,</i></p> <p>6 <i>Shemaiah, and Joiarib, Jedaiah,</i></p> <p>7 <i>Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, Jedaiah. These were the chief of the priests and of their brethren in the days of Jeshua.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Moreover the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and Mattaniah, which was over the thanksgiving, he and his brethren.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Also Bakbukiah and Unni, their brethren, were over against them in the watches.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And Jeshua begat Joiakim, Joiakim also begat Eliashib, and Eliashib begat Joiada,</i></p> <p>11 <i>And Joiada begat Jonathan, and Jonathan begat Jaddua.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And in the days of Joiakim were priests, the chief of the fathers: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah;</i></p> <p>13 <i>Of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan;</i></p> <p>14 <i>Of Melicu, Jonathan; of Shebaniah, Joseph;</i></p> | <p>These are the priests and Levites who came up with Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,</p> <p>Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,</p> <p>Shechaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,</p> <p>Iddo, Ginnetho, Abijah,</p> <p>Mijamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,</p> <p>Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah,</p> <p>Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, and Jedaiah. These were the leaders of the priests and their brothers in the days of Jeshua.</p> <p>The Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and Mattaniah, who with his brothers was in charge of the songs of thanksgiving.</p> <p>Bakbukiah and Unni and their brothers stood opposite them in the services.</p> <p>Jeshua begat Joiakim, Joiakim begat Eliashib, Eliashib begat Joiada,</p> <p>Joiada begat Jonathan, and Jonathan begat Jaddua.</p> <p>In the days of Joiakim, the priestly family heads were: for Seraiah, Meraiah; for Jeremiah, Hananiah;</p> <p>for Ezra, Meshullam; for Amariah, Jehohanan;</p> <p>for Melicu, Jonathan; for Shebaniah, Joseph;</p> |
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- 15 *Of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai;* for Harim, Adna; for Meraioth, Helkai;
- 16 *Of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam;* for Iddo, Zechariah; for Ginnethon, Meshullam;
- 17 *Of Abijah, Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah, Piltai;* for Abijah, Zichri; for Miniamin, for Moadiah, Piltai;
- 18 *Of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah, Jehonathan;* for Bilgah, Shammua; for Shemaiah, Jehonathan;
- 19 *And of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;* for Joiarib, Mattenai; for Jedaiah, Uzzi;
- 20 *Of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber;* for Sallai, Kallai; for Amok, Eber;
- 21 *Of Hilkiah, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah, Nethaneel.* for Hilkiah, Hashabiah; for Jedaiah, Nethanel.
- 22 *The Levites in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, and Johanan, and Jaddua, were recorded chief of the fathers: also the priests, to the reign of Darius the Persian.* The Levites in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, Johanan, and Jaddua were recorded as heads of families, as were the priests, until the reign of Darius the Persian.
- 23 *The sons of Levi, the chief of the fathers, were written in the book of the chronicles, even until the days of Johanan the son of Eliashib.* The sons of Levi, the heads of families, were recorded in the Book of the Chronicles until the days of Johanan the son of Eliashib.
- 24 *And the chief of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brethren over against them, to praise and to give thanks, according to the commandment of David the man of God, ward over against ward.* The heads of the Levites were Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brothers over against them, to praise and give thanks, according to the commandment of David the man of God, group corresponding to group.
- 25 *Mattaniah, and Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, Akkub, were porters keeping the ward at the thresholds of the gates.* Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, and Akkub were gatekeepers standing guard at the thresholds of the gates.

- 26 *These were in the days of Joiakim the son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor, and of Ezra the priest, the scribe.* These served in the days of Joiakim the son of Jeshua, son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor and of Ezra the priest and scribe.
- 27 *And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem, to keep the dedication with gladness, both with thanksgivings, and with singing, with cymbals, psalteries, and with harps.* At the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem, the Levites were sought out from wherever they lived and were brought to Jerusalem to celebrate the dedication with joy — with thanksgiving, singing, cymbals, harps, and lyres.
- 28 *And the sons of the singers gathered themselves together, both out of the plain country round about Jerusalem, and from the villages of Netophathi;* The sons of the singers gathered from the surrounding region around Jerusalem and from the villages of the Netophathites,
- 29 *Also from the house of Gilgal, and out of the fields of Geba and Azmavet: for the singers had builded them villages round about Jerusalem.* from Beth-gilgal and from the farms of Geba and Azmaveth, for the singers had built villages for themselves around Jerusalem.
- 30 *And the priests and the Levites purified themselves, and purified the people, and the gates, and the wall.* The priests and the Levites purified themselves. They purified the people, the gates, and the wall.
- 31 *Then I brought up the princes of Judah upon the wall, and appointed two great companies of them that gave thanks, whereof one went on the right hand upon the wall toward the dung gate:* Then I brought the leaders of Judah up on top of the wall and appointed two large choirs to give thanks. One went in procession to the right along the top of the wall toward the Refuse Gate.
- 32 *And after them went Hoshaiiah, and half of the princes of Judah,* Behind them went Hoshaiiah and half of the leaders of Judah,
- 33 *And Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam,* with Azariah, Ezra, Meshullam,
- 34 *Judah, and Benjamin, and Shemaiah, and Jeremiah,* Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah, and Jeremiah,

- 35 *And certain of the priests' sons with trumpets; namely, Zechariah the son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Michaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph:* some of the sons of the priests with trumpets: Zechariah the son of Jonathan, son of Shemaiah, son of Mattaniah, son of Michaiah, son of Zaccur, son of Asaph;
- 36 *And his brethren, Shemaiah, and Azarael, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethaneel, and Judah, Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God, and Ezra the scribe before them.* his brothers Shemaiah, Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah, and Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God. Ezra the scribe walked ahead of them.
- 37 *And at the fountain gate, which was over against them, they went up by the stairs of the city of David, at the going up of the wall, above the house of David, even unto the water gate eastward.* At the Fountain Gate they went straight up the stairs of the City of David, at the ascent of the wall, above the house of David, to the Water Gate on the east.
- 38 *And the other company of them that gave thanks went over against them, and I after them, and the half of the people upon the wall, from beyond the tower of the furnaces even unto the broad wall;* The second choir giving thanks went to the left. I followed it with half of the people along the top of the wall, past the Tower of the Ovens to the Broad Wall,
- 39 *And from above the gate of Ephraim, and above the old gate, and above the fish gate, and the tower of Hananeel, and the tower of Meah, even unto the sheep gate: and they stood still in the prison gate.* over the Gate of Ephraim, over the Jeshanah Gate, over the Fish Gate, the Tower of Hananel, and the Tower of the Hundred, to the Sheep Gate. They came to a halt at the Gate of the Guard.
- 40 *So stood the two companies of them that gave thanks in the house of God, and I, and the half of the rulers with me:* So both choirs took their places in the house of God, and so did I, along with half of the officials with me,

- 41 *And the priests; Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Michaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets;* the priests Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Michaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets,
- 42 *And Maaseiah, and Shemaiah, and Eleazar, and Uzzi, and Jehohanan, and Malchijah, and Elam, and Ezer. And the singers sang loud, with Jezrahiah their overseer.* Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malchijah, Elam, and Ezer. The singers sang loudly, with Jezrahiah as their leader.
- 43 *Also that day they offered great sacrifices, and rejoiced: for God had made them rejoice with great joy: the wives also and the children rejoiced: so that the joy of Jerusalem was heard even afar off.* That day they offered great sacrifices and rejoiced, for God had made them rejoice with great joy. The women and children also rejoiced. The joy of Jerusalem was heard far away.
- 44 *And at that time were some appointed over the chambers for the treasures, for the offerings, for the firstfruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them out of the fields of the cities the portions of the law for the priests and Levites: for Judah rejoiced for the priests and for the Levites that waited.* On that day men were appointed over the storerooms for the contributions, the firstfruits, and the tithes, to gather into them the portions required by the Law from the fields of the towns for the priests and Levites, for Judah rejoiced over the priests and Levites who were serving.
- 45 *And both the singers and the porters kept the ward of their God, and the ward of the purification, according to the commandment of David, and of Solomon his son.* They performed the service of their God and the service of purification, as did the singers and the gatekeepers, according to the command of David and his son Solomon.
- 46 *For in the days of David and Asaph of old there were chief of the singers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving unto God.* For long ago in the days of David and Asaph, there were directors of the singers and songs of praise and thanksgiving to God.

- 47 *And all Israel in the days of Zerubbabel, and in the days of Nehemiah, gave the portions of the singers and the porters, every day his portion: and they sanctified holy things unto the Levites; and the Levites sanctified them unto the children of Aaron.*
- In the days of Zerubbabel and in the days of Nehemiah, all Israel gave the daily portions for the singers and the gatekeepers. They also set apart the portion for the Levites, and the Levites set apart the portion for the sons of Aaron.

Words in this chapter:

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Zerubbabel (*zeh-RUB-ah-bel*) — The governor who led the first return of exiles from Babylon — laid the foundation of the second temple; his name means 'born in Babylon' or 'seed of Babylon.'

Cross-References:

v27 — 1 Chr 15:16

v31 — Neh 2:13

v37 — Neh 2:14; Neh 3:26

v38 — Neh 3:8; Neh 3:11

v39 — Neh 3:1; Neh 8:16; Neh 3:6; Neh 3:3

v43 — Ps 92:4; Ezra 3:13

v44 — Neh 13:12-13; Neh 10:37-39

Chapter 13

On Nehemiah's return from Babylon he found that Tobiah had been given a room in the temple courts, the Levites had not received their portions, the Sabbath was being profaned by merchants, and Jews had married foreign women. Nehemiah expelled Tobiah, restored the

tithes, shut the gates on the Sabbath, and rebuked those who had intermarried.

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| 1 <i>On that day they read in the book of Moses in the audience of the people; and therein was found written, that the Ammonite and the Moabite should not come into the congregation of God for ever;</i> | On that day the Book of Moses was read aloud to the people. In it was found written that no Ammonite or Moabite should ever be admitted into the assembly of God, |
| 2 <i>Because they met not the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them, that he should curse them: howbeit our God turned the curse into a blessing.</i> | because they had not met the people of Israel with bread and water but had hired Balaam to curse them — though our God turned the curse into a blessing. |
| 3 <i>Now it came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude.</i> | When the people heard this law, they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude. |
| 4 <i>And before this, Eliashib the priest, having the oversight of the chamber of the house of our God, was allied unto Tobiah:</i> | Before this, Eliashib the priest, who had been placed in charge of the storerooms of the house of our God, and who was related to Tobiah, |
| 5 <i>And he had prepared for him a great chamber, where aforetime they laid the meat offerings, the frankincense, and the vessels, and the tithes of the corn, the new wine, and the oil, which was commanded to be given to the Levites, and the singers, and the porters; and the offerings of the priests.</i> | had prepared for him a large room where previously they had stored the grain offerings, the frankincense, the vessels, the tithes of grain, new wine, and oil, which were commanded for the Levites, the singers, and the gatekeepers, and the contributions for the priests. |
| 6 <i>But in all this time was not I at Jerusalem: for in the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon came I unto the king, and after certain days obtained I leave of the king:</i> | While all this was happening I was not in Jerusalem, for in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I had gone to the king. After some time I asked leave of the king |

- 7 *And I came to Jerusalem, and understood of the evil that Eliashib did for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God.* I returned to Jerusalem. I then discovered the evil that Eliashib had done for Tobiah, in preparing a room for him in the courts of the house of God.
- 8 *And it grieved me sore: therefore I cast forth all the household stuff of Tobiah out of the chamber.* This made me very angry. I threw all of Tobiah's household goods out of the room.
- 9 *Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers: and thither brought I again the vessels of the house of God, with the meat offering and the frankincense.* I gave orders. They cleansed the rooms. Then I brought back the vessels of the house of God, the grain offering, and the frankincense.
- 10 *And I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them: for the Levites and the singers, that did the work, were fled every one to his field.* I also learned that the portions of the Levites had not been given to them, so that the Levites and the singers who did the work had fled each to his own field.
- 11 *Then contended I with the rulers, and said, Why is the house of God forsaken? And I gathered them together, and set them in their place.* So I confronted the officials and said, "Why is the house of God forsaken?" I gathered the Levites together and restored them to their posts.
- 12 *Then brought all Judah the tithe of the corn and the new wine and the oil unto the treasuries.* Then all Judah brought the tithe of grain, new wine, and oil to the storehouses.
- 13 *And I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah: for they were counted faithful, and their office was to distribute unto their brethren.* I appointed as treasurers over the storehouses Shelemiah the priest, Zadok the scribe, and Pedaiah of the Levites, and alongside them Hanan the son of Zaccur, son of Mattaniah. They were considered trustworthy. It was their duty to distribute the portions to their brothers.

- 14 *Remember me, O my God, concerning this, and wipe not out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for the offices thereof.* Remember me, O my God, for this, and do not blot out my faithful deeds that I have done for the house of my God and for its service.
- 15 *In those days saw I in Judah some treading wine presses on the sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading asses; as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Jerusalem on the sabbath day: and I testified against them in the day wherein they sold victuals.* In those days I saw people in Judah treading winepresses on the Sabbath and bringing in grain, loading it on donkeys — as well as wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of loads — and bringing them to Jerusalem on the Sabbath day. I warned them against selling food on that day.
- 16 *There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, which brought fish, and all manner of ware, and sold on the sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.* Residents of Tyre who lived there were bringing in fish and all kinds of merchandise and selling it on the Sabbath to the people of Judah and in Jerusalem.
- 17 *Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said unto them, What evil thing is this that ye do, and profane the sabbath day?* So I confronted the nobles of Judah and said to them, "What is this evil thing you are doing, profaning the Sabbath?
- 18 *Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this evil upon us, and upon this city? yet ye bring more wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.* Did not your ancestors do the same things, and did not our God bring all this disaster on us and on this city? Now you are bringing more wrath on Israel by profaning the Sabbath."

- 19 *And it came to pass, that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the sabbath, I commanded that the gates should be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the sabbath: and some of my servants set I at the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the sabbath day.* When it began to grow dark at the gates of Jerusalem before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be shut and not opened until after the Sabbath. I stationed some of my own servants at the gates so that no load could be brought in on the Sabbath day.
- 20 *So the merchants and sellers of all kind of ware lodged without Jerusalem once or twice.* So the merchants and sellers of all kinds of goods lodged outside Jerusalem once or twice.
- 21 *Then I testified against them, and said unto them, Why lodge ye about the wall? if ye do so again, I will lay hands on you. And from that time forth came they no more on the sabbath.* Then I warned them and said to them, "Why are you staying near the wall? If you do this again, I will arrest you." From that time on they did not come on the Sabbath.
- 22 *And I commanded the Levites that they should cleanse themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the sabbath day. Remember me, O my God, concerning this also, and spare me according to the greatness of thy mercy.* Then I commanded the Levites to purify themselves and come and guard the gates, to keep the Sabbath day holy. Remember me for this also, O my God, and spare me according to the greatness of Your mercy.
- 23 *In those days also saw I Jews that had married wives of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab:* In those days I also saw Jews who had married women from Ashdod, Ammon, and Moab.
- 24 *And their children spake half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people.* Half of their children spoke the language of Ashdod or the language of one of the other peoples, and could not speak the language of Judah.

- 25 *And I contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, saying, Ye shall not give your daughters unto their sons, nor take their daughters unto your sons, or for yourselves.* I rebuked them and called curses down on them. I beat some of them and pulled out their hair. I made them swear by God, saying, "You shall not give your daughters to their sons, nor shall you take their daughters for your sons or for yourselves.
- 26 *Did not Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? yet among many nations was there no king like him, who was beloved of his God, and God made him king over all Israel: nevertheless even him did outlandish women cause to sin.* Did not Solomon king of Israel sin in this very way? Among the many nations there was no king like him. He was loved by his God. God made him king over all Israel. Yet even He was led into sin by foreign women.
- 27 *Shall we then hearken unto you to do all this great evil, to transgress against our God in marrying strange wives?* Must we now hear that you too are doing all this great evil, being unfaithful to our God by marrying foreign women?"
- 28 *And one of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son in law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me.* One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was a son-in-law of Sanballat the Horonite. So I drove him away from me.
- 29 *Remember them, O my God, because they have defiled the priesthood, and the covenant of the priesthood, and of the Levites.* Remember them, O my God, because they have defiled the priesthood and the covenant of the priests and the Levites.
- 30 *Thus cleansed I them from all strangers, and appointed the wards of the priests and the Levites, every one in his business;* So I cleansed them from everything foreign and assigned duties to the priests and Levites, each to his own task,
- 31 *And for the wood offering, at times appointed, and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.* I arranged for the supply of wood at appointed times and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

Words in this chapter:

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 23:3-5; Neh 9:3

v2 — Deut 23:5; Josh 24:9-10; Num 23:8-11; Ps 109:28; Mic 6:5

v3 — Neh 9:2; Ex 12:38

v4 — Neh 12:44

v6 — Neh 5:14

v14 — Ps 122:6-9; Heb 6:10; Neh 13:22; Neh 13:31; 2 Chr 31:20-21

v15 — Neh 10:31; Ex 34:21; Neh 13:21

v22 — Neh 12:30; Neh 13:14

v26 — 1 Kgs 11:1-8; Eccl 7:26; 1 Kgs 3:13

v27 — Ezra 10:2

v29 — Neh 6:14

v31 — Neh 13:14; Neh 13:22

Esther

Author: Unknown — possibly Mordecai, as suggested by the book's detailed knowledge of Persian court customs and the internal mention of Mordecai's records (Est 9:20). Jewish tradition also names Ezra or the men of the Great Synagogue.

Date written: c. 460–400 BC, during the reign of Ahasuerus (Xerxes I of Persia).

Written to: The Jewish diaspora throughout the Persian empire, to explain the origin of the feast of Purim and to encourage the scattered nation.

Setting: The Jews who did not return to Jerusalem under Zerubbabel remain scattered throughout the Persian empire. Esther is one of them — an orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, who becomes queen of Persia without the king knowing she is Jewish. When Haman the Agagite plots the extermination of all Jews in the empire, everything turns on whether Esther will risk her life to intervene.

Where this sits historically: The story unfolds c. 483–473 BC at Susa under Xerxes I (Ahasuerus), in the years between his failed invasion of Greece (Thermopylae and Salamis, 480 BC) and his assassination in 465 BC.

Contemporaries: The second temple had been finished a generation earlier under Zerubbabel, Haggai, and Zechariah, while Ezra and Nehemiah would arrive in Jerusalem only after Esther's day.

Big themes:

- Providence — God's name never appears in the book, yet His hand is unmistakable behind every coincidence, delay, and reversal
- Courage — Esther's decision to approach the king unsummoned, knowing it may cost her life, is one of Scripture's great acts of courage
- Reversal — the gallows Haman built for Mordecai is the gallows he hangs on; the day planned for Jewish extermination becomes a day of Jewish victory
- Jewish identity in exile — Mordecai's refusal to bow to Haman and Esther's willingness to identify as a Jew both at great personal cost
- The feast of Purim — the celebration established in chapter 9 is still observed by Jewish communities worldwide

Key passages: Est 2:17; 4:14; 4:16; 6:13; 8:17

How it fits: Esther is set during the reign of Xerxes I, between Ezra chapters 6 and 7 — after the temple is rebuilt but before Ezra's mission. It shows that God protects His people even among those who never returned to the land. The survival of the Jewish people in Persia ensures that the messianic line continues.

Chapter 1

King Ahasuerus held a great banquet in Susa and on the seventh day commanded Queen Vashti to appear before his guests, but she refused. On the advice of his counselors, the king deposed Vashti and decreed that every man should rule his own household.

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| <p>1 Now it came to pass in the days of Ahasuerus, (this is Ahasuerus which reigned, from India even unto Ethiopia, over an hundred and seven and twenty provinces:)</p> | <p>This is what happened in the days of Ahasuerus — the Ahasuerus who reigned from India to Ethiopia over 127 provinces.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ahasuerus** (ah-haz-yoo-EE-rus) — "mighty eye" — The Persian king identified with Xerxes I (c. 486–465 BC), ruler of the vast Persian empire from India to Ethiopia. His court at Shushan (Susa) is the setting for the entire book.

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| <p>2 That in those days, when the king Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his kingdom, which was in Shushan the palace,</p> | <p>In those days, when King Ahasuerus sat on his royal throne in the citadel of Shushan,</p> |
| <p>3 In the third year of his reign, he made a feast unto all his princes and his servants; the power of Persia and Media, the nobles and princes of the provinces, being before him:</p> | <p>In the third year of his reign he gave a banquet for all his officials and servants. The army of Persia and Media, the nobles and the governors of the provinces, were present before him,</p> |
| <p>4 When he shewed the riches of his glorious kingdom and the honour of his excellent majesty many days, even an hundred and fourscore days.</p> | <p>While he displayed the wealth of his glorious kingdom and the splendor of his greatness for many days — 180 days.</p> |
| <p>5 And when these days were expired, the king made a feast unto all the people that were present in Shushan the palace, both unto great and small, seven days, in the court of the garden of the king's palace;</p> | <p>When those days were completed, the king gave a banquet lasting seven days for all the people present in the citadel of Shushan, from the greatest to the least, in the courtyard of the garden of the king's palace.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>Where were white, green, and blue, hangings, fastened with cords of fine linen and purple to silver rings and pillars of marble: the beds were of gold and silver, upon a pavement of red, and blue, and white, and black, marble.</i></p> | <p>There were white, green, and blue hangings fastened with cords of fine linen and purple to silver rings and marble pillars. The couches were of gold and silver on a pavement of red, blue, white, and black marble.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And they gave them drink in vessels of gold, (the vessels being diverse one from another,) and royal wine in abundance, according to the state of the king.</i></p> | <p>Drinks were served in golden vessels — vessels of varying design — and the royal wine flowed freely, in keeping with the king's generosity.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And the drinking was according to the law; none did compel: for so the king had appointed to all the officers of his house, that they should do according to every man's pleasure.</i></p> | <p>The drinking was by no fixed rule, for the king had instructed all the stewards of his household to serve each guest as he wished.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Also Vashti the queen made a feast for the women in the royal house which belonged to king Ahasuerus.</i></p> | <p>Queen Vashti also gave a banquet for the women in the royal palace of King Ahasuerus.</p> |
- **NAME NOTE** — **Vashti** (VASH-ty) — "beautiful" — *The queen of Persia who refused the king's summons to display her beauty before his drunken guests. Her deposition opened the way for Esther to become queen.*
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| <p>10 <i>On the seventh day, when the heart of the king was merry with wine, he commanded Mehuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Carcas, the seven chamberlains that served in the presence of Ahasuerus the king,</i></p> | <p>On the seventh day, when the king was in high spirits from wine, he commanded Mehuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha and Abagtha, Zethar and Carcas — the seven chamberlains who served King Ahasuerus —</p> |
| <p>11 <i>To bring Vashti the queen before the king with the crown royal, to shew the people and the princes her beauty: for she was fair to look on.</i></p> | <p>To bring Queen Vashti before the king wearing her royal crown, to display her beauty to the people and the officials, for she was beautiful.</p> |

- 12 *But the queen Vashti refused to come at the king's commandment by his chamberlains: therefore was the king very wroth, and his anger burned in him.* But Queen Vashti refused to come at the king's command delivered by the chamberlains. The king became furious and his anger burned within him.
- 13 *Then the king said to the wise men, which knew the times, (for so was the king's manner toward all that knew law and judgment:* Then the king consulted the wise men who knew the laws and customs, for it was the king's practice to consult experts in law and justice.
- 14 *And the next unto him was Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshish, Meres, Marsena, and Memucan, the seven princes of Persia and Media, which saw the king's face, and which sat the first in the kingdom;)* His closest advisers were Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshish, Meres, Marsena, and Memucan — the seven princes of Persia and Media who had access to the king and sat in the first ranks of the kingdom.
- 15 *What shall we do unto the queen Vashti according to law, because she hath not performed the commandment of the king Ahasuerus by the chamberlains?* He asked, "According to the law, what is to be done to Queen Vashti, because she has not obeyed the command of King Ahasuerus delivered by the chamberlains?"
- 16 *And Memucan answered before the king and the princes, Vashti the queen hath not done wrong to the king only, but also to all the princes, and to all the people that are in all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus.* Memucan replied in the presence of the king and the officials, "Queen Vashti has done wrong not only to the king but also to all the officials and all the peoples who are in all the provinces of King Ahasuerus.
- 17 *For this deed of the queen shall come abroad unto all women, so that they shall despise their husbands in their eyes, when it shall be reported, The king Ahasuerus commanded Vashti the queen to be brought in before him, but she came not.* For this deed of the queen will become known to all women. They will despise their husbands in their eyes, when it is reported that King Ahasuerus commanded Queen Vashti to be brought before him but she did not come.

- 18 *Likewise shall the ladies of Persia and Media say this day unto all the king's princes, which have heard of the deed of the queen. Thus shall there arise too much contempt and wrath.* This very day the ladies of Persia and Media who have heard of the queen's conduct will be telling the same thing to all the king's officials, and there will be no end of contempt and anger.
- 19 *If it please the king, let there go a royal commandment from him, and let it be written among the laws of the Persians and the Medes, that it be not altered, That Vashti come no more before king Ahasuerus; and let the king give her royal estate unto another that is better than she.* If it pleases the king, let a royal decree go out from him and let it be written into the laws of Persia and Media so that it cannot be repealed — that Vashti is never again to come before King Ahasuerus. Let the king give her royal position to someone better than she.
- 20 *And when the king's decree which he shall make shall be published throughout all his empire, (for it is great,) all the wives shall give to their husbands honour, both to great and small.* When the decree made by the king is proclaimed throughout his entire kingdom — for it is vast — all the wives will give honor to their husbands, from the greatest to the least."
- 21 *And the saying pleased the king and the princes; and the king did according to the word of Memucan:* This pleased the king and the officials, and the king did as Memucan proposed.
- 22 *For he sent letters into all the king's provinces, into every province according to the writing thereof, and to every people after their language, that every man should bear rule in his own house, and that it should be published according to the language of every people.* He sent letters to all the royal provinces, to each province in its own script and to each people in their own language, proclaiming that every man should be master in his own household.

Words in this chapter:

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Dan 9:1; Ezra 4:6
- v2 — Neh 1:1; 2 Sam 7:1
- v3 — Mark 6:21; Dan 5:1; Esth 2:18
- v6 — Amos 6:4
- v10 — Esth 7:9; Judg 16:25
- v11 — Prov 31:30; Mark 6:21-22; Prov 16:9; 1 Sam 25:3; 2 Sam 14:25
- v12 — Prov 19:12
- v13 — 1 Chr 12:32
- v14 — 2 Kgs 25:19
- v19 — 1 Sam 15:28; Esth 8:8
- v20 — Col 3:18; Eph 5:33; Eph 5:22; 1 Pet 3:1-7
- v22 — Esth 8:9; Esth 3:12; Eph 5:22-24

Chapter 2

A search was made for a new queen; Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned. Mordecai uncovered a plot by two of the king's chamberlains to assassinate Ahasuerus, and the matter was recorded in the royal chronicles.

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| <p>1 <i>After these things, when the wrath of king Ahasuerus was appeased, he remembered Vashti, and what she had done, and what was decreed against her.</i></p> | <p>After these events, when King Ahasuerus's fury had subsided, he thought about Vashti and what she had done and what had been decreed against her.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then said the king's servants that ministered unto him, Let there be fair young virgins sought for the king:</i></p> | <p>Then the king's personal attendants suggested, "Let beautiful young virgins be sought out for the king.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And let the king appoint officers in all the provinces of his kingdom, that they may gather together all the fair young virgins unto Shushan the palace, to the house of the women, unto the custody of Hege the king's chamberlain, keeper of the women; and let their things for purification be given them:</i></p> | <p>Let the king appoint officers in all the provinces of his kingdom to gather all these beautiful young women to the house of the women in the citadel of Shushan. Let them be placed under the care of Hegai, the king's chamberlain who is in charge of the women, and let beauty treatments be given to them.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And let the maiden which pleaseth the king be queen instead of Vashti. And the thing pleased the king; and he did so.</i></p> | <p>Then let the young woman who pleases the king become queen instead of Vashti." This advice pleased the king. He followed it.</p> |

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| <p>5 <i>Now in Shushan the palace there was a certain Jew, whose name was Mordecai, the son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, a Benjamite;</i></p> | <p>Now there was in the citadel of Shushan a Jew named Mordecai the son of Jair, son of Shimei, son of Kish, a Benjaminite,</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mordecai** (MOR-deh-ky) — Possibly from Babylonian "Marduk" — Esther's older cousin and guardian, a Benjamite descendant of Kish. He sat at the king's gate, refused to bow to Haman, uncovered a plot against the king, and was ultimately exalted to second in the kingdom.

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| <p>6 <i>Who had been carried away from Jerusalem with the captivity which had been carried away with Jeconiah king of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away.</i></p> | <p>Who had been carried into exile from Jerusalem among those taken captive with Jeconiah king of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried away.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And he brought up Hadassah, that is, Esther, his uncle's daughter: for she had neither father nor mother, and the maid was fair and beautiful; whom Mordecai, when her father and mother were dead, took for his own daughter.</i></p> | <p>He was the guardian of Hadassah — that is, Esther — his uncle's daughter, for she had neither father nor mother. The young woman was fair and beautiful. When her father and mother died, Mordecai had adopted her as his own daughter.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Esther** (ES-ter) — "star" (Persian); her Hebrew name Hadassah means "myrtle" — A Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, who became queen of Persia and risked her life to save the Jewish people from Haman's genocide plot.

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| <p>8 <i>So it came to pass, when the king's commandment and his decree was heard, and when many maidens were gathered together unto Shushan the palace, to the custody of Hegai, that Esther was brought also unto the king's house, to the custody of Hegai, keeper of the women.</i></p> | <p>When the king's order and decree were proclaimed and many young women were brought to the citadel of Shushan under the care of Hegai, Esther also was taken to the king's palace and entrusted to Hegai, who was in charge of the women.</p> |
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- 9 *And the maiden pleased him, and she obtained kindness of him; and he speedily gave her her things for purification, with such things as belonged to her, and seven maidens, which were meet to be given her, out of the king's house: and he preferred her and her maids unto the best place of the house of the women.* The young woman pleased him and won his favor. He quickly provided her with her beauty treatments and special food. He assigned seven chosen young women from the king's palace to attend her and moved her and her attendants to the best place in the house of the women.
- 10 *Esther had not shewed her people nor her kindred: for Mordecai had charged her that she should not shew it.* Esther had not revealed her people or her family background, because Mordecai had told her not to reveal it.
- 11 *And Mordecai walked every day before the court of the women's house, to know how Esther did, and what should become of her.* Every day Mordecai would walk back and forth near the courtyard of the house of the women to find out how Esther was doing and what was happening to her.
- 12 *Now when every maid's turn was come to go in to king Ahasuerus, after that she had been twelve months, according to the manner of the women, (for so were the days of their purifications accomplished, to wit, six months with oil of myrrh, and six months with sweet odours, and with other things for the purifying of the women;)* Each young woman's turn came to go in to King Ahasuerus after she had completed twelve months of preparation prescribed for the women — six months with oil of myrrh and six months with perfumes and other cosmetics for women.
- 13 *Then thus came every maiden unto the king; whatsoever she desired was given her to go with her out of the house of the women unto the king's house.* In this way a young woman went to the king: she was given whatever she asked for to take with her from the house of the women to the king's palace.

- 14 *In the evening she went, and on the morrow she returned into the second house of the women, to the custody of Shaashgaz, the king's chamberlain, which kept the concubines: she came in unto the king no more, except the king delighted in her, and that she were called by name.* In the evening she went, and in the morning she returned to the second house of the women under the care of Shaashgaz, the king's chamberlain who was in charge of the concubines. She would not go to the king again unless he was pleased with her and summoned her by name.
- 15 *Now when the turn of Esther, the daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai, who had taken her for his daughter, was come to go in unto the king, she required nothing but what Hegai the king's chamberlain, the keeper of the women, appointed. And Esther obtained favour in the sight of all them that looked upon her.* When the turn came for Esther the daughter of Abihail — the uncle of Mordecai, who had adopted her as his daughter — to go to the king, she asked for nothing except what Hegai the king's chamberlain, who was in charge of the women, suggested. Esther won the favor of everyone who saw her.
- 16 *So Esther was taken unto king Ahasuerus into his house royal in the tenth month, which is the month Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign.* Esther was taken to King Ahasuerus in his royal palace in the tenth month, the month of Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign.
- 17 *And the king loved Esther above all the women, and she obtained grace and favour in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown upon her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.* The king loved Esther more than all the other women. She won his grace and favor more than all the other young women. He placed the royal crown on her head and made her queen in place of Vashti.
- 18 *Then the king made a great feast unto all his princes and his servants, even Esther's feast; and he made a release to the provinces, and gave gifts, according to the state of the king.* Then the king gave a great banquet — Esther's banquet — for all his officials and servants. He granted a holiday to the provinces and distributed gifts with royal generosity.

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| 19 | <i>And when virgins were gathered together the second time, then Mordecai sat in the king's gate.</i> | When young women were gathered together a second time, Mordecai was sitting at the king's gate. |
| 20 | <i>Esther had not yet shewed her kindred nor her people; as Mordecai had charged her: for Esther did the commandment of Mordecai, like as when she was brought up with him.</i> | Esther had still not revealed her family background or her people, just as Mordecai had instructed her. Esther continued to follow Mordecai's directions just as she had when she was being raised by him. |
| 21 | <i>In those days, while Mordecai sat in the king's gate, two of the king's chamberlains, Bigthan and Teresh, of those which kept the door, were wroth, and sought to lay hand on the king Ahasuerus.</i> | During those days, while Mordecai was sitting at the king's gate, Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king's chamberlains who guarded the doorway, became angry and conspired to assassinate King Ahasuerus. |
| 22 | <i>And the thing was known to Mordecai, who told it unto Esther the queen; and Esther certified the king thereof in Mordecai's name.</i> | Mordecai found out about it and told Queen Esther, who in turn reported it to the king in Mordecai's name. |
| 23 | <i>And when inquisition was made of the matter, it was found out; therefore they were both hanged on a tree: and it was written in the book of the chronicles before the king.</i> | When the matter was investigated and found to be true, the two chamberlains were both hanged on a tree. This was recorded in the book of the chronicles in the king's presence. |

Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Esther (*ES-ter*) — A Jewish woman who became queen of Persia — risked her life to save the Jewish people from Haman's plot; her name may mean 'star' (Persian) or 'hidden.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v4 — Matt 14:6; Matt 20:16
- v5 — 2 Sam 16:5
- v6 — 2 Kgs 24:14-15; Jer 24:1; 2 Chr 36:20
- v7 — Esth 2:15
- v8 — Esth 2:3
- v9 — Gen 39:21; Prov 16:7; Esth 2:12; Esth 2:3; Dan 1:9
- v10 — Esth 2:20; Matt 10:16; Eph 6:1; Esth 3:8
- v12 — Prov 7:17; 1 Thess 4:4-5
- v15 — Song 6:9; Esth 2:3; Acts 7:10; Esth 9:29
- v17 — Ps 113:7-8; Luke 1:48-52; Ezek 17:24; 1 Sam 2:8; Ps 75:6-7
- v19 — Esth 2:21
- v21 — Esth 6:2

Chapter 3

The king promoted Haman the Agagite above all the princes, but Mordecai refused to bow to him. Enraged, Haman persuaded the king to issue a decree to destroy all the Jews in the empire on a date chosen by casting lots (Purim).

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| 1 <i>After these things did king Ahasuerus promote Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, and advanced him, and set his seat above all the princes that were with him.</i> | After these events, King Ahasuerus honored Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Agagite, promoting him and giving him a seat of honor higher than all the other officials. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Haman** (HAY-man) — "magnificent" — *The son of Hammedatha the Agagite, exalted to chief minister of Persia. His hatred of Mordecai drove him to plot the extermination of all Jews in the empire. He was ultimately hanged on the gallows he had built for Mordecai.*

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| 2 <i>And all the king's servants, that were in the king's gate, bowed, and revered Haman: for the king had so commanded concerning him. But Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reverence.</i> | All the king's servants at the king's gate bowed down and paid honor to Haman, for so the king had commanded concerning him. But Mordecai would not bow down or pay him honor. |
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- 3 *Then the king's servants, which were in the king's gate, said unto Mordecai, Why transgressest thou the king's commandment?* Then the king's servants at the king's gate asked Mordecai, "Why do you disobey the king's command?"
- 4 *Now it came to pass, when they spake daily unto him, and he hearkened not unto them, that they told Haman, to see whether Mordecai's matters would stand: for he had told them that he was a Jew.* When they spoke to him day after day and he would not listen, they told Haman in order to see whether Mordecai's reason would be accepted, for he had told them that he was a Jew.
- 5 *And when Haman saw that Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reverence, then was Haman full of wrath.* When Haman saw that Mordecai would not bow down or pay him honor, Haman was enraged.
- 6 *And he thought scorn to lay hands on Mordecai alone; for they had shewed him the people of Mordecai: wherefore Haman sought to destroy all the Jews that were throughout the whole kingdom of Ahasuerus, even the people of Mordecai.* But he scorned the idea of laying hands on Mordecai alone, since they had told him Mordecai's people. So Haman sought to destroy all the Jews — the people of Mordecai — throughout the whole kingdom of Ahasuerus.
- 7 *In the first month, that is, the month Nisan, in the twelfth year of king Ahasuerus, they cast Pur, that is, the lot, before Haman from day to day, and from month to month, to the twelfth month, that is, the month Adar.* In the first month, the month of Nisan, in the twelfth year of King Ahasuerus, they cast Pur — that is, the lot — before Haman, from day to day and from month to month. It fell on the twelfth month, the month of Adar.
- 8 *And Haman said unto king Ahasuerus, There is a certain people scattered abroad and dispersed among the people in all the provinces of thy kingdom; and their laws are diverse from all people; neither keep they the king's laws: therefore it is not for the king's profit to suffer them.* Then Haman said to King Ahasuerus, "There is a certain people scattered and dispersed among the peoples in all the provinces of your kingdom. Their customs are different from those of every other people. They do not keep the king's laws. It is not in the king's best interest to tolerate them.

- 9 *If it please the king, let it be written that they may be destroyed: and I will pay ten thousand talents of silver to the hands of those that have the charge of the business, to bring it into the king's treasuries.* If it pleases the king, let a decree be issued to destroy them. I will pay ten thousand talents of silver into the royal treasury for those who carry out this business."
- 10 *And the king took his ring from his hand, and gave it unto Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the Jews' enemy.* So the king took his signet ring from his hand and gave it to Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the enemy of the Jews.
- 11 *And the king said unto Haman, The silver is given to thee, the people also, to do with them as it seemeth good to thee.* The king said to Haman, "The silver is given to you, and the people also, to do with them as seems good to you."
- 12 *Then were the king's scribes called on the thirteenth day of the first month, and there was written according to all that Haman had commanded unto the king's lieutenants, and to the governors that were over every province, and to the rulers of every people of every province according to the writing thereof, and to every people after their language; in the name of king Ahasuerus was it written, and sealed with the king's ring.* On the thirteenth day of the first month the royal scribes were summoned. They wrote out all Haman's orders to the king's lieutenants, to the governors of each province, and to the officials of each people — to each province in its own script and to each people in their own language. It was written in the name of King Ahasuerus and sealed with the king's signet ring.
- 13 *And the letters were sent by posts into all the king's provinces, to destroy, to kill, and to cause to perish, all Jews, both young and old, little children and women, in one day, even upon the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is the month Adar, and to take the spoil of them for a prey.* Dispatches were sent by couriers to all the king's provinces with orders to destroy, kill, and annihilate all the Jews — young and old, women and children — on a single day, the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, the month of Adar, and to plunder their goods.

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| <p>14 <i>The copy of the writing for a commandment to be given in every province was published unto all people, that they should be ready against that day.</i></p> | <p>A copy of the written decree was to be issued as law in every province, proclaimed to all peoples, so that they would be ready for that day.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>The posts went out, being hastened by the king's commandment, and the decree was given in Shushan the palace. And the king and Haman sat down to drink; but the city Shushan was perplexed.</i></p> | <p>The couriers went out urgently at the king's command, and the decree was issued in the citadel of Shushan. The king and Haman sat down to drink, but the city of Shushan was in confusion.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Num 24:7; Esth 5:11; Dan 6:2; 1 Sam 15:33
- v4 — Gen 39:10
- v6 — Ps 83:4
- v8 — Ezra 4:12-15; Acts 16:20-21
- v10 — Gen 41:42; Esth 8:2; Esth 7:6
- v12 — 1 Kgs 21:8
- v15 — Esth 8:15

Chapter 4

Mordecai mourned in sackcloth and sent word to Esther urging her to go before the king to plead for her people. Esther agreed, telling Mordecai to gather the Jews to fast for three days, declaring, 'If I perish, I perish.'

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| <p>1 <i>When Mordecai perceived all that was done, Mordecai rent his clothes, and put on sackcloth with ashes, and went out into the midst of the city, and cried with a loud and a bitter cry;</i></p> | <p>When Mordecai learned all that had been done, he tore his clothes and put on sackcloth and ashes. He went out into the middle of the city, wailing loudly and bitterly.</p> |
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- 2 *And came even before the king's gate: for none might enter into the king's gate clothed with sackcloth.* He went as far as the front of the king's gate, for no one was allowed to enter the king's gate clothed in sackcloth.
- 3 *And in every province, whithersoever the king's commandment and his decree came, there was great mourning among the Jews, and fasting, and weeping, and wailing; and many lay in sackcloth and ashes.* In every province wherever the king's command and decree reached, there was great mourning among the Jews, with fasting, weeping, and lamenting. Many lay in sackcloth and ashes.
- 4 *So Esther's maids and her chamberlains came and told it her. Then was the queen exceedingly grieved; and she sent raiment to clothe Mordecai, and to take away his sackcloth from him: but he received it not.* When Esther's young women and her chamberlains came and told her, the queen was deeply distressed. She sent clothes for Mordecai to wear instead of his sackcloth. But he would not accept them.
- 5 *Then called Esther for Hatach, one of the king's chamberlains, whom he had appointed to attend upon her, and gave him a commandment to Mordecai, to know what it was, and why it was.* Then Esther summoned Hathach, one of the king's chamberlains who had been assigned to attend her, and ordered him to go to Mordecai to find out what was happening and why.
- 6 *So Hatach went forth to Mordecai unto the street of the city, which was before the king's gate.* So Hathach went out to Mordecai in the open square of the city before the king's gate.
- 7 *And Mordecai told him of all that had happened unto him, and of the sum of the money that Haman had promised to pay to the king's treasuries for the Jews, to destroy them.* Mordecai told him everything that had happened and the exact amount of silver Haman had promised to pay into the royal treasury for the destruction of the Jews.

- 8 *Also he gave him the copy of the writing of the decree that was given at Shushan to destroy them, to shew it unto Esther, and to declare it unto her, and to charge her that she should go in unto the king, to make supplication unto him, and to make request before him for her people.* He also gave him a copy of the written decree issued in Shushan for their destruction, so that he might show it to Esther and explain it to her. He told him to urge Esther to go before the king to beg for mercy and to plead with him for her people.
- 9 *And Hathach came and told Esther the words of Mordecai.* Hathach went back and reported Mordecai's words to Esther.
- 10 *Again Esther spake unto Hathach, and gave him commandment unto Mordecai;* Then Esther told Hathach to go back with this message for Mordecai:
- 11 *All the king's servants, and the people of the king's provinces, do know, that whosoever, whether man or woman, shall come unto the king into the inner court, who is not called, there is one law of his to put him to death, except such to whom the king shall hold out the golden sceptre, that he may live: but I have not been called to come in unto the king these thirty days.* "All the king's servants and the people of the king's provinces know that if any man or woman goes to the king in the inner court without being summoned, there is one law — that he be put to death, unless the king holds out the golden scepter so that he may live. I have not been summoned to come before the king for thirty days."
- 12 *And they told to Mordecai Esther's words.* When they reported Esther's words to Mordecai,
- 13 *Then Mordecai commanded to answer Esther, Think not with thyself that thou shalt escape in the king's house, more than all the Jews.* Mordecai told them to reply to Esther, "Do not think that in the king's palace you will escape any more than all the other Jews."

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| <p>14 <i>For if thou altogether holdest thy peace at this time, then shall there enlargement and deliverance arise to the Jews from another place; but thou and thy father's house shall be destroyed: and who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?</i></p> <p>15 <i>Then Esther bade them return Mordecai this answer,</i></p> <p>16 <i>Go, gather together all the Jews that are present in Shushan, and fast ye for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day: I also and my maidens will fast likewise; and so will I go in unto the king, which is not according to the law: and if I perish, I perish.</i></p> <p>17 <i>So Mordecai went his way, and did according to all that Esther had commanded him.</i></p> | <p>For if you keep silent at this time, relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father's family will perish. And who knows whether you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?"</p> <p>Then Esther sent this reply to Mordecai:</p> <p>"Go, gather all the Jews who are found in Shushan and fast for me. Do not eat or drink for three days, night or day. My young women and I will fast the same way. Then I will go to the king, though it is against the law, and if I perish, I perish."</p> <p>So Mordecai went away and did everything Esther had commanded him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Dan 9:3; 2 Sam 1:11; 2 Sam 13:19; Ezek 27:30-31
- v3** — Isa 22:12
- v4** — Ps 77:2
- v6** — Esth 4:3
- v7** — Esth 3:2-15
- v8** — Eccl 10:4
- v11** — Esth 5:1-2; Dan 2:9; Esth 8:4
- v13** — Prov 24:10-12
- v14** — Gen 45:4-8; 1 Sam 12:22; Deut 32:36; Isa 54:17; Jer 30:11
- v16** — Acts 20:24; 2 Chr 20:3; Joel 2:12-17; Luke 9:24; Gen 18:19

Chapter 5

Esther put on her royal robes and entered the king's court; the king extended his scepter and offered her up to half the kingdom. Esther invited the king and Haman to a banquet, then to a second banquet the next day. Haman went home rejoicing but was enraged again at Mordecai, and his wife urged him to build a gallows.

- 1 *Now it came to pass on the third day, that Esther put on her royal apparel, and stood in the inner court of the king's house, over against the king's house: and the king sat upon his royal throne in the royal house, over against the gate of the house.*

On the third day Esther put on her royal robes and stood in the inner court of the king's palace, opposite the king's hall. The king was sitting on his royal throne in the throne room, facing the entrance.
- 2 *And it was so, when the king saw Esther the queen standing in the court, that she obtained favour in his sight: and the king held out to Esther the golden sceptre that was in his hand. So Esther drew near, and touched the top of the sceptre.*

When the king saw Queen Esther standing in the court, she won favor in his sight. He held out to her the golden scepter that was in his hand. Esther approached and touched the tip of the scepter.
- 3 *Then said the king unto her, What wilt thou, queen Esther? and what is thy request? it shall be even given thee to the half of the kingdom.*

The king asked, "What is it, Queen Esther? What is your request? It shall be given to you, even to half the kingdom."
- 4 *And Esther answered, If it seem good unto the king, let the king and Haman come this day unto the banquet that I have prepared for him.*

Esther said, "If it pleases the king, let the king and Haman come today to the banquet I have prepared for him."
- 5 *Then the king said, Cause Haman to make haste, that he may do as Esther hath said. So the king and Haman came to the banquet that Esther had prepared.*

The king said, "Bring Haman quickly so that we may do as Esther has said." So the king and Haman came to the banquet Esther had prepared.

- 6 *And the king said unto Esther at the banquet of wine, What is thy petition? and it shall be granted thee: and what is thy request? even to the half of the kingdom it shall be performed.* While they were drinking wine, the king said to Esther, "What is your petition? It shall be granted to you. What is your request? Even to half the kingdom, it shall be fulfilled."
- 7 *Then answered Esther, and said, My petition and my request is;* Esther replied, "My petition and request is this:
- 8 *If I have found favour in the sight of the king, and if it please the king to grant my petition, and to perform my request, let the king and Haman come to the banquet that I shall prepare for them, and I will do to morrow as the king hath said.* If I have found favor in the king's sight and if it pleases the king to grant my petition and fulfill my request, let the king and Haman come to the banquet I will prepare for them. Tomorrow I will do as the king has said."
- 9 *Then went Haman forth that day joyful and with a glad heart: but when Haman saw Mordecai in the king's gate, that he stood not up, nor moved for him, he was full of indignation against Mordecai.* Haman went out that day joyful and in good spirits. But when he saw Mordecai at the king's gate and observed that he neither rose nor showed any sign of respect for him, Haman was filled with rage against Mordecai.
- 10 *Nevertheless Haman refrained himself: and when he came home, he sent and called for his friends, and Zeresh his wife.* Nevertheless, Haman restrained himself and went home. He sent for his friends and his wife Zeresh,
- 11 *And Haman told them of the glory of his riches, and the multitude of his children, and all the things wherein the king had promoted him, and how he had advanced him above the princes and servants of the king.* Haman told them about his vast wealth and his many sons, and all the ways the king had honored him and elevated him above the other officials and servants of the king.

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| <p>12 <i>Haman said moreover, Yea, Esther the queen did let no man come in with the king unto the banquet that she had prepared but myself; and to morrow am I invited unto her also with the king.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Yet all this availeth me nothing, so long as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the king's gate.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then said Zeresh his wife and all his friends unto him, Let a gallows be made of fifty cubits high, and to morrow speak thou unto the king that Mordecai may be hanged thereon: then go thou in merrily with the king unto the banquet. And the thing pleased Haman; and he caused the gallows to be made.</i></p> | <p>"Moreover," Haman said, "Queen Esther invited no one but me to accompany the king to the banquet she prepared, and tomorrow I am invited by her again along with the king.</p> <p>But all this gives me no satisfaction as long as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the king's gate."</p> <p>his wife Zeresh and all his friends said to him, "Have a gallows made fifty cubits high, and in the morning ask the king to have Mordecai hanged on it. Then go to the banquet with the king in good spirits." This pleased Haman. He had the gallows made.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Esther (*ES-ter*) — A Jewish woman who became queen of Persia — risked her life to save the Jewish people from Haman's plot; her name may mean 'star' (Persian) or 'hidden.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Esth 6:4; Esth 4:16; Rev 3:21; 1 Pet 3:3-5
- v2 — Esth 8:4; Esth 4:11; Prov 21:1
- v3 — Mark 6:23; Esth 7:2; Esth 5:6; Esth 9:12; Matt 20:20-22
- v6 — Esth 7:2; Esth 5:3; Esth 9:12
- v8 — Prov 16:9
- v9 — Esth 3:5
- v10 — Esth 6:13
- v11 — Esth 9:7-10
- v12 — Prov 27:1
- v14 — Esth 6:4; 1 Kgs 21:7; Esth 7:9-10; Ps 37:14; Ps 37:32

Chapter 6

That night the king could not sleep and had the royal chronicles read to him, discovering that Mordecai had never been honored for saving his life. The king asked Haman how to honor a man the king delights in; Haman, thinking it was himself, described a lavish reward — then was humiliated when he had to bestow it on Mordecai.

- 1 *On that night could not the king sleep, and he commanded to bring the book of records of the chronicles; and they were read before the king.* That night the king could not sleep. He ordered the book of the chronicles, the record of his reign, to be brought and read to him.
- 2 *And it was found written, that Mordecai had told of Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king's chamberlains, the keepers of the door, who sought to lay hand on the king Ahasuerus.* It was found recorded that Mordecai had reported on Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king's chamberlains who guarded the doorway, who had conspired to assassinate King Ahasuerus.
- 3 *And the king said, What honour and dignity hath been done to Mordecai for this? Then said the king's servants that ministered unto him, There is nothing done for him.* The king asked, "What honor and recognition has been given to Mordecai for this?" His attendants replied, "Nothing has been done for him."
- 4 *And the king said, Who is in the court? Now Haman was come into the outward court of the king's house, to speak unto the king to hang Mordecai on the gallows that he had prepared for him.* The king asked, "Who is in the court?" Now Haman had just entered the outer court of the king's palace to ask the king to have Mordecai hanged on the gallows he had prepared for him.
- 5 *And the king's servants said unto him, Behold, Haman standeth in the court. And the king said, Let him come in.* The king's attendants said, "Haman is standing in the court." The king said, "Bring him in."

- 6 *So Haman came in. And the king said unto him, What shall be done unto the man whom the king delighteth to honour? Now Haman thought in his heart, To whom would the king delight to do honour more than to myself?* So Haman came in. The king asked him, "What should be done for the man the king delights to honor?" Haman thought to himself, "Who would the king want to honor more than me?"
- 7 *And Haman answered the king, For the man whom the king delighteth to honour,* So Haman said to the king, "For the man the king delights to honor,
- 8 *Let the royal apparel be brought which the king useth to wear, and the horse that the king rideth upon, and the crown royal which is set upon his head:* let royal robes be brought — robes that the king has worn — and a horse that the king has ridden, with a royal crown placed on its head.
- 9 *And let this apparel and horse be delivered to the hand of one of the king's most noble princes, that they may array the man withal whom the king delighteth to honour, and bring him on horseback through the street of the city, and proclaim before him, Thus shall it be done to the man whom the king delighteth to honour.* Let the robes and the horse be handed over to one of the king's most noble officials. Let him robe the man the king delights to honor and lead him on horseback through the city streets, proclaiming before him, "This is what is done for the man the king delights to honor!"
- 10 *Then the king said to Haman, Make haste, and take the apparel and the horse, as thou hast said, and do even so to Mordecai the Jew, that sitteth at the king's gate: let nothing fail of all that thou hast spoken.* The king said to Haman, "Go at once. Take the robes and the horse, as you have suggested, and do this for Mordecai the Jew who sits at the king's gate. Do not leave out anything you have mentioned."

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| <p>11 <i>Then took Haman the apparel and the horse, and arrayed Mordecai, and brought him on horseback through the street of the city, and proclaimed before him, Thus shall it be done unto the man whom the king delighteth to honour.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Mordecai came again to the king's gate. But Haman hasted to his house mourning, and having his head covered.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And Haman told Zeresh his wife and all his friends every thing that had befallen him. Then said his wise men and his wife Zeresh unto him, If Mordecai be of the seed of the Jews, before whom thou hast begun to fall, thou shalt not prevail against him, but shalt surely fall before him.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And while they were yet talking with him, came the king's chamberlains, and hasted to bring Haman unto the banquet that Esther had prepared.</i></p> | <p>So Haman took the robes and the horse. He put the robes on Mordecai and led him on horseback through the city streets, proclaiming before him, "This is what is done for the man the king delights to honor!"</p> <p>Then Mordecai returned to the king's gate, but Haman hurried home, mourning with his head covered.</p> <p>Haman told his wife Zeresh and all his friends everything that had happened to him. His advisers and his wife Zeresh said to him, "If Mordecai, before whom you have begun to fall, is of Jewish descent, you will not prevail against him but will surely fall before him."</p> <p>While they were still speaking, the king's chamberlains arrived and hurried Haman away to the banquet Esther had prepared.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Esther (*ES-ter*) — A Jewish woman who became queen of Persia — risked her life to save the Jewish people from Haman's plot; her name may mean 'star' (Persian) or 'hidden.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Dan 2:1; Dan 6:18; Esth 10:2; Esth 5:8; Esth 2:23
- v3 — Eccl 9:15
- v4 — Esth 5:14
- v6 — Prov 16:18
- v8 — 1 Kgs 1:33

v9 — Gen 41:43; 1 Kgs 1:33-34

v10 — Dan 4:37

v11 — Esth 9:3; Luke 1:52

v12 — 2 Sam 15:30

v13 — Prov 28:18; Hos 14:9; Gen 40:19; Gen 41:8; Dan 2:12

v14 — Esth 5:8

Chapter 7

At Esther's second banquet she revealed her Jewish identity and accused Haman of plotting to destroy her people. The king was furious; when Haman fell on Esther's couch pleading for mercy, the king had him hanged on the very gallows Haman had built for Mordecai.

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| 1 <i>So the king and Haman came to banquet with Esther the queen.</i> | So the king and Haman came to dine with Queen Esther. |
| 2 <i>And the king said again unto Esther on the second day at the banquet of wine, What is thy petition, queen Esther? and it shall be granted thee: and what is thy request? and it shall be performed, even to the half of the kingdom.</i> | On the second day, while they were drinking wine, the king again asked, "What is your petition, Queen Esther? It will be given to you. What is your request? Even to half the kingdom, it will be fulfilled." |
| 3 <i>Then Esther the queen answered and said, If I have found favour in thy sight, O king, and if it please the king, let my life be given me at my petition, and my people at my request:</i> | Then Queen Esther answered, "If I have found favor in your sight, O king, and if it pleases the king, let my life be given me as my petition and my people as my request. |
| 4 <i>For we are sold, I and my people, to be destroyed, to be slain, and to perish. But if we had been sold for bondmen and bondwomen, I had held my tongue, although the enemy could not countervail the king's damage.</i> | For we have been sold — I and my people — to be destroyed, killed, and annihilated. If we had merely been sold as male and female slaves, I would have kept silent, although the enemy could not countervail the king's damage." |
| 5 <i>Then the king Ahasuerus answered and said unto Esther the queen, Who is he, and where is he, that durst presume in his heart to do so?</i> | Then King Ahasuerus said to Queen Esther, "Who is he? Where is the man who has dared to do this?" |

- 6 *And Esther said, The adversary and enemy is this wicked Haman. Then Haman was afraid before the king and the queen.* Esther said, "A foe and an enemy — this wicked Haman!" Then Haman was terrified before the king and the queen.
- 7 *And the king arising from the banquet of wine in his wrath went into the palace garden: and Haman stood up to make request for his life to Esther the queen; for he saw that there was evil determined against him by the king.* The king rose in his anger from the banquet and went into the palace garden. Haman, realizing that the king had decided his fate, stayed behind to beg Queen Esther for his life.
- 8 *Then the king returned out of the palace garden into the place of the banquet of wine; and Haman was fallen upon the bed whereon Esther was. Then said the king, Will he force the queen also before me in the house? As the word went out of the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face.* The king returned from the palace garden to the room where they were drinking wine, and Haman had thrown himself on the couch where Esther was reclining. The king said, "Will he even assault the queen in my presence, in my own house?" As soon as the words left the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face.
- 9 *And Harbonah, one of the chamberlains, said before the king, Behold also, the gallows fifty cubits high, which Haman had made for Mordecai, who had spoken good for the king, standeth in the house of Haman. Then the king said, Hang him thereon.* Then Harbonah, one of the chamberlains in attendance on the king, said, "Look — the gallows standing at Haman's house, fifty cubits high, which Haman himself prepared for Mordecai, who spoke up to help the king." The king said, "Hang him thereon."
- 10 *So they hanged Haman on the gallows that he had prepared for Mordecai. Then was the king's wrath pacified.* So they hanged Haman on the gallows he had prepared for Mordecai. Then the king's wrath subsided.

Words in this chapter:

Esther (*ES-ter*) — A Jewish woman who became queen of Persia — risked her life to save the Jewish people from Haman's plot; her name may mean 'star' (Persian) or 'hidden.'

Mordecai (*MOR-deh-ky*) — Esther's cousin and guardian — refused to bow to Haman; uncovered a plot against the king; ultimately honored above Haman; his name may be Babylonian in origin.

Cross-References:

v2 — John 16:24; Esth 5:3

v3 — Jer 38:26

v4 — Esth 3:9; Deut 28:68; Esth 3:13

v6 — Job 18:5-12

v8 — Esth 1:6

v9 — Ps 7:15-16; Prov 11:5-6; Esth 5:14; Esth 1:10; Ps 141:10

v10 — Ps 7:16; Dan 6:24

Chapter 8

The king gave Haman's estate to Esther and his signet ring to Mordecai. Since the first decree could not be revoked, the king authorized Mordecai to write a new decree allowing the Jews to defend themselves; the Jews had light, gladness, and joy.

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| <p>1 <i>On that day did the king Ahasuerus give the house of Haman the Jews' enemy unto Esther the queen. And Mordecai came before the king; for Esther had told what he was unto her.</i></p> | <p>That same day King Ahasuerus gave Queen Esther the estate of Haman, the enemy of the Jews. Mordecai came before the king, for Esther had revealed how he was related to her.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the king took off his ring, which he had taken from Haman, and gave it unto Mordecai. And Esther set Mordecai over the house of Haman.</i></p> | <p>The king took off his signet ring, which he had reclaimed from Haman, and gave it to Mordecai. And Esther appointed Mordecai over the estate of Haman.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Esther spake yet again before the king, and fell down at his feet, and besought him with tears to put away the mischief of Haman the Agagite, and his device that he had devised against the Jews.</i></p> | <p>Esther again spoke to the king. She fell at his feet and wept, pleading with him to avert the evil plan of Haman the Agagite and the plot he had devised against the Jews.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then the king held out the golden sceptre toward Esther. So Esther arose, and stood before the king,</i></p> | <p>The king held out the golden scepter to Esther, and Esther rose and stood before the king.</p> |

- 5 *And said, If it please the king, and if I have found favour in his sight, and the thing seem right before the king, and I be pleasing in his eyes, let it be written to reverse the letters devised by Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, which he wrote to destroy the Jews which are in all the king's provinces:* She said, "If it pleases the king, and if I have found favor in his sight, and if it seems right to the king and I am pleasing in his eyes, let an order be written to revoke the letters devised by Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, which he wrote to destroy the Jews throughout all the king's provinces.
- 6 *For how can I endure to see the evil that shall come unto my people? or how can I endure to see the destruction of my kindred?* For how can I endure to see the calamity that is coming to my people? Or how can I endure to see the destruction of my family?"
- 7 *Then the king Ahasuerus said unto Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, Behold, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and him they have hanged upon the gallows, because he laid his hand on the Jews.* King Ahasuerus replied to Queen Esther and to Mordecai the Jew, "See, I have given Esther the estate of Haman. They have hanged him on the gallows because he stretched out his hand against the Jews.
- 8 *Write ye also for the Jews, as it liketh you, in the king's name, and seal it with the king's ring: for the writing which is written in the king's name, and sealed with the king's ring, may no man reverse.* Now you may write in the king's name whatever seems good to you concerning the Jews, and seal it with the king's signet ring, for a decree written in the king's name and sealed with the king's ring cannot be revoked."

- 9 *Then were the king's scribes called at that time in the third month, that is, the month Sivan, on the three and twentieth day thereof; and it was written according to all that Mordecai commanded unto the Jews, and to the lieutenants, and the deputies and rulers of the provinces which are from India unto Ethiopia, an hundred twenty and seven provinces, unto every province according to the writing thereof, and unto every people after their language, and to the Jews according to their writing, and according to their language.* The royal scribes were summoned at that time — it was the third month, the month of Sivan, on the twenty-third day. Everything Mordecai commanded was written to the Jews and to the lieutenants, governors, and officials of the provinces from India to Ethiopia — 127 provinces — to each province in its own script and to each people in their own language, and also to the Jews in their own script and language.
- 10 *And he wrote in the king Ahasuerus' name, and sealed it with the king's ring, and sent letters by posts on horseback, and riders on mules, camels, and young dromedaries:* He wrote in the name of King Ahasuerus and sealed the letters with the king's signet ring. He sent the letters by couriers on horseback — riders on mules, camels, and young dromedaries —
- 11 *Wherein the king granted the Jews which were in every city to gather themselves together, and to stand for their life, to destroy, to slay, and to cause to perish, all the power of the people and province that would assault them, both little ones and women, and to take the spoil of them for a prey,* Granting the Jews in every city the right to assemble and protect themselves, to destroy, kill, and annihilate any armed force of any people or province that might attack them, their children and women, and to plunder the property of their enemies,
- 12 *Upon one day in all the provinces of king Ahasuerus, namely, upon the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is the month Adar.* All on a single day throughout all the provinces of King Ahasuerus — on the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, the month of Adar.

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| <p>13 <i>The copy of the writing for a commandment to be given in every province was published unto all people, and that the Jews should be ready against that day to avenge themselves on their enemies.</i></p> | <p>A copy of the written decree was to be issued as law in every province, proclaimed to all peoples, so that the Jews would be ready on that day to take revenge on their enemies.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>So the posts that rode upon mules and camels went out, being hastened and pressed on by the king's commandment. And the decree was given at Shushan the palace.</i></p> | <p>The couriers riding on mules and camels went out urgently, pressed on by the king's command. And the decree was issued in the citadel of Shushan.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And Mordecai went out from the presence of the king in royal apparel of blue and white, and with a great crown of gold, and with a garment of fine linen and purple: and the city of Shushan rejoiced and was glad.</i></p> | <p>Mordecai went out from the presence of the king in royal robes of blue and white, with a large golden crown and a garment of fine linen and purple, and the city of Shushan shouted and rejoiced.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>The Jews had light, and gladness, and joy, and honour.</i></p> | <p>For the Jews there was light and gladness, joy and honor.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And in every province, and in every city, whithersoever the king's commandment and his decree came, the Jews had joy and gladness, a feast and a good day. And many of the people of the land became Jews; for the fear of the Jews fell upon them.</i></p> | <p>In every province and in every city, wherever the king's command and his decree came, the Jews had joy and gladness, a feast and a holiday. And many of the peoples of the land declared themselves Jews, for the fear of the Jews had fallen on them.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Esth 2:7; Esth 2:15; Prov 13:22
- v2 — Esth 3:10
- v4 — Esth 5:2; Esth 4:11
- v5 — Esth 7:3

v6 — Esth 7:4

v8 — Esth 1:19; Esth 3:12

v9 — Esth 1:22; Esth 1:1

v11 — Ps 37:14-15; Esth 3:13; Ezek 39:10; Ps 146:6-9; Ps 137:8

v12 — Esth 9:1

v15 — Luke 16:19; Esth 1:6; Esth 6:8; Prov 29:2; Matt 6:29

v16 — Prov 11:10; Ps 97:11; Ps 18:28; Esth 4:1-3; Ps 30:5-11

v17 — Deut 11:25; Esth 9:19

Chapter 9

On the thirteenth day of Adar the Jews struck down their enemies throughout the empire, killing Haman's ten sons. The feast of Purim was established as an annual two-day celebration on the fourteenth and fifteenth of Adar to remember their deliverance.

- 1 *Now in the twelfth month, that is, the month Adar, on the thirteenth day of the same, when the king's commandment and his decree drew near to be put in execution, in the day that the enemies of the Jews hoped to have power over them, (though it was turned to the contrary, that the Jews had rule over them that hated them;)* In the twelfth month — the month of Adar — on the thirteenth day, when the king's command and decree were about to be carried out, on the very day when the enemies of the Jews hoped to overpower them, it was turned around so that the Jews themselves overpowered those who hated them.
- 2 *The Jews gathered themselves together in their cities throughout all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus, to lay hand on such as sought their hurt: and no man could withstand them; for the fear of them fell upon all people.* The Jews assembled in their cities throughout all the provinces of King Ahasuerus to attack those who sought to harm them. No one could stand against them, for the fear of them had fallen on all peoples.
- 3 *And all the rulers of the provinces, and the lieutenants, and the deputies, and officers of the king, helped the Jews; because the fear of Mordecai fell upon them.* All the officials of the provinces, the lieutenants, the governors, and the royal administrators supported the Jews, because the fear of Mordecai had fallen on them.

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| <p>4 <i>For Mordecai was great in the king's house, and his fame went out throughout all the provinces: for this man Mordecai waxed greater and greater.</i></p> | <p>For Mordecai was prominent in the king's palace. His fame was spreading throughout all the provinces, for he was growing more and more powerful.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Thus the Jews smote all their enemies with the stroke of the sword, and slaughter, and destruction, and did what they would unto those that hated them.</i></p> | <p>The Jews struck down all their enemies with the sword, killing and destroying them. They did as they pleased to those who hated them.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And in Shushan the palace the Jews slew and destroyed five hundred men.</i></p> | <p>In the citadel of Shushan the Jews killed and destroyed 500 men.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And Parshandatha, and Dalphon, and Aspatha,</i></p> | <p>They also killed Parshandatha, Dalphon, Aspatha,</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And Poratha, and Adalia, and Aridatha,</i></p> | <p>Poratha, Adalia, Aridatha,</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And Parmashta, and Arisai, and Aridai, and Vajezatha,</i></p> | <p>Parmashta, Arisai, Aridai, and Vaizatha —</p> |
| <p>10 <i>The ten sons of Haman the son of Hammedatha, the enemy of the Jews, slew they; but on the spoil laid they not their hand.</i></p> | <p>The ten sons of Haman the son of Hammedatha, the enemy of the Jews. But they did not lay their hands on the plunder.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>On that day the number of those that were slain in Shushan the palace was brought before the king.</i></p> | <p>On that day the number of those killed in the citadel of Shushan was reported to the king.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And the king said unto Esther the queen, The Jews have slain and destroyed five hundred men in Shushan the palace, and the ten sons of Haman; what have they done in the rest of the king's provinces? now what is thy petition? and it shall be granted thee: or what is thy request further? and it shall be done.</i></p> | <p>The king said to Queen Esther, "In the citadel of Shushan the Jews have killed and destroyed 500 men and the ten sons of Haman. What have they done in the rest of the king's provinces? Now what is your petition? It shall be granted to you. And what is your further request? It shall be done."</p> |

- 13 *Then said Esther, If it please the king, let it be granted to the Jews which are in Shushan to do to morrow also according unto this day's decree, and let Haman's ten sons be hanged upon the gallows.* Esther said, "If it pleases the king, let the Jews in Shushan also be permitted tomorrow to act according to today's decree, and let Haman's ten sons be hanged on the gallows."
- 14 *And the king commanded it so to be done: and the decree was given at Shushan; and they hanged Haman's ten sons.* So the king commanded this to be done. The decree was issued in Shushan, and Haman's ten sons were hanged.
- 15 *For the Jews that were in Shushan gathered themselves together on the fourteenth day also of the month Adar, and slew three hundred men at Shushan; but on the prey they laid not their hand.* The Jews in Shushan assembled again on the fourteenth day of the month of Adar and killed 300 men in Shushan. But they did not lay their hands on the plunder.
- 16 *But the other Jews that were in the king's provinces gathered themselves together, and stood for their lives, and had rest from their enemies, and slew of their foes seventy and five thousand, but they laid not their hands on the prey,* The rest of the Jews in the king's provinces assembled and defended themselves, gaining relief from their enemies. They killed 75,000 of those who hated them. But they did not lay their hands on the plunder.
- 17 *On the thirteenth day of the month Adar; and on the fourteenth day of the same rested they, and made it a day of feasting and gladness.* This was on the thirteenth day of the month of Adar. On the fourteenth day they rested and made it a day of feasting and rejoicing.
- 18 *But the Jews that were at Shushan assembled together on the thirteenth day thereof, and on the fourteenth thereof; and on the fifteenth day of the same they rested, and made it a day of feasting and gladness.* But the Jews in Shushan had assembled on the thirteenth and fourteenth days of the month. They rested on the fifteenth day and made it a day of feasting and rejoicing.

- 19 *Therefore the Jews of the villages, that dwell in the unwalled towns, made the fourteenth day of the month Adar a day of gladness and feasting, and a good day, and of sending portions one to another.* This is why the rural Jews — those who live in villages without walls — celebrate the fourteenth day of the month of Adar as a day of gladness and feasting, a holiday, and a time for sending gifts of food to one another.
- 20 *And Mordecai wrote these things, and sent letters unto all the Jews that were in all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus, both nigh and far,* Mordecai recorded these events and sent letters to all the Jews in all the provinces of King Ahasuerus, both near and far,
- 21 *To stablish this among them, that they should keep the fourteenth day of the month Adar, and the fifteenth day of the same, yearly,* Directing them to celebrate the fourteenth and fifteenth days of the month of Adar each year
- 22 *As the days wherein the Jews rested from their enemies, and the month which was turned unto them from sorrow to joy, and from mourning into a good day: that they should make them days of feasting and joy, and of sending portions one to another, and gifts to the poor.* As the days on which the Jews got relief from their enemies, and as the month in which their sorrow was turned into joy and their mourning into a holiday — so that they should make them days of feasting and joy, of sending gifts of food to one another and presents to the poor.
- 23 *And the Jews undertook to do as they had begun, and as Mordecai had written unto them;* So the Jews agreed to what they had already begun to practice and to what Mordecai had written to them.
- 24 *Because Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Agagite, the enemy of all the Jews, had devised against the Jews to destroy them, and had cast Pur, that is, the lot, to consume them, and to destroy them;* For Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the enemy of all the Jews, had plotted against the Jews to destroy them and had cast the Pur — that is, the lot — to crush and destroy them.

- 25 *But when Esther came before the king, he commanded by letters that his wicked device, which he devised against the Jews, should return upon his own head, and that he and his sons should be hanged on the gallows.* But when Esther came before the king, he ordered by letter that his wicked device which he had devised against the Jews should turn back on his own head, and that he and his sons should be hanged on the gallows.
- 26 *Wherefore they called these days Purim after the name of Pur. Therefore for all the words of this letter, and of that which they had seen concerning this matter, and which had come unto them,* Therefore these days are called Purim, from the word Pur. Because of all the instructions in this letter and of what they had seen and experienced concerning this matter,
- 27 *The Jews ordained, and took upon them, and upon their seed, and upon all such as joined themselves unto them, so as it should not fail, that they would keep these two days according to their writing, and according to their appointed time every year;* The Jews established and accepted as a custom for themselves, their descendants, and all who joined them, that without fail they would celebrate these two days every year as written and at the appointed time.
- 28 *And that these days should be remembered and kept throughout every generation, every family, every province, and every city; and that these days of Purim should not fail from among the Jews, nor the memorial of them perish from their seed.* These days of Purim are to be remembered and celebrated by every generation, every family, every province, and every city. These days of Purim will never cease among the Jews, nor will the memory of them fade from their descendants.
- 29 *Then Esther the queen, the daughter of Abihail, and Mordecai the Jew, wrote with all authority, to confirm this second letter of Purim.* Then Queen Esther daughter of Abihail, together with Mordecai the Jew, wrote with full authority to confirm this second letter about Purim.

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| <p>30 <i>And he sent the letters unto all the Jews, to the hundred twenty and seven provinces of the kingdom of Ahasuerus, with words of peace and truth,</i></p> | <p>Letters were sent to all the Jews in the 127 provinces of the kingdom of Ahasuerus with words of peace and truth,</p> |
| <p>31 <i>To confirm these days of Purim in their times appointed, according as Mordecai the Jew and Esther the queen had enjoined them, and as they had decreed for themselves and for their seed, the matters of the fastings and their cry.</i></p> | <p>To establish these days of Purim at their appointed times as Mordecai the Jew and Queen Esther had decreed for them, and as they had established for themselves and their descendants, with regulations for fasting and lamentation.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>And the decree of Esther confirmed these matters of Purim; and it was written in the book.</i></p> | <p>The command of Esther established these customs for Purim. It was recorded in writing.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Esth 3:13; Esth 8:12; Ps 30:11
- v2 — Esth 8:17; Esth 8:11
- v3 — Ezra 8:36
- v4 — 2 Sam 3:1; 1 Chr 11:9
- v10 — Esth 8:11; Esth 5:11
- v12 — Esth 7:2; Esth 5:6
- v16 — Esth 8:11; Esth 9:2; Lev 26:7-8
- v19 — Esth 8:17
- v22 — Ps 30:11
- v25 — Ps 7:16
- v29 — Esth 9:20
- v31 — Esth 4:3

Chapter 10

King Ahasuerus imposed tribute on the land, and the greatness of Mordecai was recorded in the royal chronicles. Mordecai the Jew was second in rank to the king and worked for the good of his people.

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| 1 | <i>And the king Ahasuerus laid a tribute upon the land, and upon the isles of the sea.</i> | King Ahasuerus imposed tribute on the land and on the coastlands of the sea. |
| 2 | <i>And all the acts of his power and of his might, and the declaration of the greatness of Mordecai, whereunto the king advanced him, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Media and Persia?</i> | All his acts of power and might, and the full account of the greatness of Mordecai to which the king elevated him, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Media and Persia? |
| 3 | <i>For Mordecai the Jew was next unto king Ahasuerus, and great among the Jews, and accepted of the multitude of his brethren, seeking the wealth of his people, and speaking peace to all his seed.</i> | For Mordecai the Jew was second in rank to King Ahasuerus and was great among the Jews, and held in high esteem by his many fellow Jews. He worked for the good of his people and spoke peace to all his family. |
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Words in this chapter:

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 24:15

v2 — Esth 8:15; Esth 9:4; Esth 2:23

v3 — Neh 2:10

Job

Author: Unknown — possibly Job himself, Moses, or another ancient writer. Jewish tradition suggests Moses.

Date written: Patriarchal era setting (c. 2000–1500 BC); one of the oldest books in the Bible.

Written to: Israel and all believers who ask why the righteous suffer.

Setting: The land of Uz, during the patriarchal period. Job is a wealthy, God-fearing man whom God allows Satan to test.

Where this sits historically: The events fall in the patriarchal era (c. 2000–1500 BC), before the giving of the Mosaic law and before Israel existed as a nation, in an age when wealth was measured in livestock and a man like Job offered sacrifices as his own household priest.

Contemporaries: Job belongs to the same general world as Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and the wisdom traditions of Edom and Arabia (Eliphaz comes from Teman in Edom) were flourishing alongside him.

Big themes:

- The suffering of the righteous and the mystery of God's purposes
- God's absolute sovereignty over creation and all events
- The failure of "retribution theology" — the friends' insistence that suffering always means hidden sin
- The limits of human wisdom before the infinite God
- God's answer from the whirlwind — not an explanation but a revelation of Himself
- Restoration — God vindicates Job and restores him double

Key passages: 1:21; 13:15; 19:25–27; 28:28; 38:1–4; 42:5–6

How it fits: Job is the Bible's deepest exploration of theodicy. Job's cry "I know that my redeemer liveth" (19:25) reaches beyond his own suffering to anticipate the coming Christ who will stand upon the earth.

Chapter 1

Job was a perfect and upright man in the land of Uz, the greatest of all the men of the east. Satan challenged Job's motives before God, and the LORD permitted Satan to destroy Job's possessions and children. Job fell to the ground, worshipped, and did not sin.

1	There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job; and that man was perfect and upright, and one that feared God, and eschewed evil.	There was a man in the land of Uz whose name was Job. That man was perfect and upright, one who feared God and shunned evil.
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Job** (JOHB) — "persecuted" — A righteous man in the land of Uz whom God allows to be tested.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Uz** (UZ) — Region of uncertain location, possibly in Edom or Arabia.

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| <p>2 <i>And there were born unto him seven sons and three daughters.</i></p> | There were born to him seven sons and three daughters. |
| <p>3 <i>His substance also was seven thousand sheep, and three thousand camels, and five hundred yoke of oxen, and five hundred she asses, and a very great household; so that this man was the greatest of all the men of the east.</i></p> | His possessions were seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred yoke of oxen, and five hundred she asses, and a very great household. So this man was the greatest of all the men of the east. |
| <p>4 <i>And his sons went and feasted in their houses, every one his day; and sent and called for their three sisters to eat and to drink with them.</i></p> | His sons went and feasted in their houses, each on his day; and they sent and called for their three sisters to eat and drink with them. |
| <p>5 <i>And it was so, when the days of their feasting were gone about, that Job sent and sanctified them, and rose up early in the morning, and offered burnt offerings according to the number of them all: for Job said, It may be that my sons have sinned, and cursed God in their hearts. Thus did Job continually.</i></p> | So it was, when the days of their feasting had run their course, that Job sent and sanctified them. He rose up early in the morning and offered burnt offerings according to the number of them all, for Job said, "It may be that my sons have sinned and cursed God in their hearts." Thus Job did continually. |
| <p>6 <i>Now there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them.</i></p> | Now there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them. |
| <p>7 <i>And the LORD said unto Satan, Whence comest thou? Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.</i></p> | The LORD said to Satan, "From where do you come?" Then Satan answered the LORD and said, "From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it." |

- 8 *And the LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and an upright man, one that feareth God, and escheweth evil?* The LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and upright man, one who fears God and shuns evil?"
- 9 *Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, Doth Job fear God for nought?* Then Satan answered the LORD and said, "Does Job fear God for nothing?"
- 10 *Hast not thou made an hedge about him, and about his house, and about all that he hath on every side? thou hast blessed the work of his hands, and his substance is increased in the land.* Have You not made a hedge around Him, and around His house, and around all that He has on every side? You have blessed the work of His hands, and His possessions are increased in the land.
- 11 *But put forth thine hand now, and touch all that he hath, and he will curse thee to thy face.* But put forth Your hand now and touch all that He has, and He will curse You to Your face."
- 12 *And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, all that he hath is in thy power; only upon himself put not forth thine hand. So Satan went forth from the presence of the LORD.* The LORD said to Satan, "See, all that he has is in your power; only on Himself do not put forth Your hand." So Satan went out from the presence of the LORD.
- 13 *And there was a day when his sons and his daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother's house:* There was a day when His sons and His daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother's house,
- 14 *And there came a messenger unto Job, and said, The oxen were plowing, and the asses feeding beside them:* and a messenger came to Job and said, "The oxen were plowing and the asses feeding beside them,
- 15 *And the Sabeans fell upon them, and took them away; yea, they have slain the servants with the edge of the sword; and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.* and the Sabeans fell on them and took them away. They have slain the servants with the edge of the sword, and I alone have escaped to tell you."

- 16 *While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, The fire of God is fallen from heaven, and hath burned up the sheep, and the servants, and consumed them; and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.* While he was yet speaking, another also came and said, "The fire of God has fallen from heaven and has burned up the sheep and the servants, and consumed them; and I alone have escaped to tell you."
- 17 *While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, The Chaldeans made out three bands, and fell upon the camels, and have carried them away, yea, and slain the servants with the edge of the sword; and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.* While he was yet speaking, another also came and said, "The Chaldeans formed three bands and fell on the camels and carried them away, and have slain the servants with the edge of the sword; and I alone have escaped to tell you."
- 18 *While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, Thy sons and thy daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother's house:* While he was yet speaking, another also came and said, "Your sons and your daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother's house,
- 19 *And, behold, there came a great wind from the wilderness, and smote the four corners of the house, and it fell upon the young men, and they are dead; and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.* and a great wind came from the wilderness and struck the four corners of the house, and it fell on the young men, and they are dead; and I alone have escaped to tell you."
- 20 *Then Job arose, and rent his mantle, and shaved his head, and fell down upon the ground, and worshipped,* Then Job arose and tore his mantle, and shaved his head, and fell down on the ground and worshipped,
- 21 *And said, Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.* and said, "Naked I came out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return there. The LORD gave, and the LORD has taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD."
- 22 *In all this Job sinned not, nor charged God foolishly.* In all this Job did not sin, nor charge God foolishly.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jas 5:11; Ezek 14:14; Ezek 14:20; Job 28:28; Job 2:3
- v2 — Job 42:13; Ps 127:3-5; Ps 107:38; Ps 128:3; Esth 5:11
- v3 — Job 29:25; Job 42:12; Judg 6:3; Prov 10:22; Num 23:7
- v5 — Job 42:8; Gen 8:20; 1 Sam 16:5; Eph 6:18; Gen 35:2-3
- v6 — Job 2:1; Job 38:7; Zech 3:1; Rev 12:9-10; 1 Kgs 22:19
- v7 — 1 Pet 5:8; Matt 12:43; Job 2:2; Rev 12:12-17
- v8 — Job 2:3; Job 1:1; Num 12:7-8; 2 Kgs 23:25; Prov 8:13
- v9 — Matt 16:26; 1 Tim 4:8; Job 21:14-15; 1 Tim 6:6; Job 1:21
- v10 — Ps 34:7; Zech 2:5; 1 Pet 1:5; Deut 28:2-6; Prov 10:22
- v11 — Job 2:5; Job 19:21; Rev 16:11
- v12 — Luke 22:31-32; 2 Cor 12:7; John 3:35-36; 1 Cor 10:13
- v21 — Eccl 5:15; 1 Tim 6:7; 1 Thess 5:18; Jas 1:17; Job 2:10

Chapter 2

Satan returned before the LORD and received permission to strike Job's body. Job's wife urged him to curse God and die, but Job refused and did not sin with his lips. His three friends arrived and sat with him in silence for seven days.

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| <p>1 <i>Again there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them to present himself before the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Again there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them to present himself before the LORD.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the LORD said unto Satan, From whence comest thou? And Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Satan, "From where do you come?" Satan answered the LORD and said, "From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And the LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and an upright man, one that feareth God, and escheweth evil? and still he holdeth fast his integrity, although thou movedst me against him, to destroy him without cause.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and upright man, one who fears God and shuns evil? And still He holds fast His integrity, although You moved me against Him, to destroy Him without cause."</p> |

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| 4 | <i>And Satan answered the LORD, and said, Skin for skin, yea, all that a man hath will he give for his life.</i> | Satan answered the LORD and said, "Skin for skin, yes, all that a man has he will give for his life. |
| 5 | <i>But put forth thine hand now, and touch his bone and his flesh, and he will curse thee to thy face.</i> | But put forth Your hand now and touch His bone and His flesh, and He will curse You to Your face." |
| 6 | <i>And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, he is in thine hand; but save his life.</i> | The LORD said to Satan, "See, he is in your hand; but spare his life." |
| 7 | <i>So went Satan forth from the presence of the LORD, and smote Job with sore boils from the sole of his foot unto his crown.</i> | So Satan went forth from the presence of the LORD and struck Job with sore boils from the sole of his foot to his crown. |
| 8 | <i>And he took him a potsherd to scrape himself withal; and he sat down among the ashes.</i> | He took a potsherd to scrape Himself with, and He sat down among the ashes. |
| 9 | <i>Then said his wife unto him, Dost thou still retain thine integrity? curse God, and die.</i> | Then his wife said to Him, "Do You still retain Your integrity? Curse God, and die." |
| 10 | <i>But he said unto her, Thou speakest as one of the foolish women speaketh. What? shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil? In all this did not Job sin with his lips.</i> | But he said to her, "You speak as one of the foolish women speaks. What? Shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil?" In all this Job did not sin with his lips. |
| 11 | <i>Now when Job's three friends heard of all this evil that was come upon him, they came every one from his own place; Eliphaz the Temanite, and Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite: for they had made an appointment together to come to mourn with him and to comfort him.</i> | Now when Job's three friends heard of all this evil that had come on him, they came each one from his own place — Eliphaz the Temanite, and Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite. They had made an appointment together to come to mourn with him and to comfort him. |

- **NAME NOTE** — **Eliphaz** (EL-ih-faz) — "my God is gold" — The Temanite; first and most moderate of Job's three friends.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Bildad** (BIL-dad) — "son of contention" — The Shuhite; second friend, appeals to tradition.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Zophar** (ZOH-far) — "chirper" — The Naamathite; harshest of Job's three friends.

- 12 *And when they lifted up their eyes afar off, and knew him not, they lifted up their voice, and wept; and they rent every one his mantle, and sprinkled dust upon their heads toward heaven.*
- When they lifted up their eyes from afar and did not recognize him, they lifted up their voice and wept; and each one tore his mantle and sprinkled dust on their heads toward heaven.
- 13 *So they sat down with him upon the ground seven days and seven nights, and none spake a word unto him: for they saw that his grief was very great.*
- So they sat down with him on the ground seven days and seven nights, and none spoke a word to him, for they saw that his grief was very great.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 1:6
- v3 — Jas 1:12; Job 27:5-6; Job 1:8; Job 9:17; Prov 16:17
- v4 — Phil 3:8-10; Matt 6:25; Matt 16:26
- v5 — Job 1:11
- v6 — 1 Cor 10:13; Luke 22:31-32; Job 1:12; Rev 2:10
- v7 — Deut 28:35; Job 30:30; Isa 1:6
- v8 — Job 42:6; Ezek 27:30; Jonah 3:6; Matt 11:21
- v9 — Job 2:5; Job 2:3; 2 Kgs 6:33; Mal 3:14; 1 Kgs 11:4
- v10 — Jas 1:12; Lam 3:38-41; Job 1:21-22; Rom 12:12; Jas 5:10-11
- v11 — Rom 12:15; Job 42:11
- v12 — Lam 2:10; Ezek 27:30; Neh 9:1; Josh 7:6
- v13 — Gen 50:10; Neh 1:4; Ezek 3:15; Isa 3:26

Chapter 3

Job breaks his silence and curses the day of his birth. He longs for death and asks why light is given to those in misery, wishing he had never been born or had died at birth.

- 1 *After this opened Job his mouth, and cursed his day.*
- After this Job opened his mouth and cursed his day.

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| 2 | <i>And Job spake, and said,</i> | Job spoke and said: |
| 3 | <i>Let the day perish wherein I was born,
and the night in which it was said,
There is a man child conceived.</i> | "Let the day perish in which I was
born, and the night in which it was
said, 'A man child is conceived.' |
| 4 | <i>Let that day be darkness; let not God
regard it from above, neither let the
light shine upon it.</i> | Let that day be darkness; let not God
regard it from above, neither let the
light shine on it. |
| 5 | <i>Let darkness and the shadow of death
stain it; let a cloud dwell upon it; let
the blackness of the day terrify it.</i> | Let darkness and the shadow of death
stain it; let a cloud dwell on it; let the
blackness of the day terrify it. |
| 6 | <i>As for that night, let darkness seize
upon it; let it not be joined unto the
days of the year, let it not come into
the number of the months.</i> | As for that night, let darkness seize on
it; let it not be joined to the days of the
year; let it not come into the number of
the months. |
| 7 | <i>Lo, let that night be solitary, let no
joyful voice come therein.</i> | Let that night be solitary; let no joyful
voice come in it. |
| 8 | <i>Let them curse it that curse the day,
who are ready to rouse up their
mourning.</i> | Let them curse it that curse the day,
who are ready to rouse up their
mourning. |
| 9 | <i>Let the stars of the twilight thereof be
dark; let it look for light, but have
none; neither let it see the dawning of
the day:</i> | Let the stars of its twilight be dark; let
it look for light, but have none; neither
let it see the dawning of the day, |
| 10 | <i>Because it shut not up the doors of my
mother's womb, nor hid sorrow from
mine eyes.</i> | because it did not shut up the doors of
my mother's womb, nor hide sorrow
from my eyes. |
| 11 | <i>Why died I not from the womb? why
did I not give up the ghost when I
came out of the belly?</i> | Why did I not die from the womb?
Why did I not give up the ghost when I
came out of the belly? |
| 12 | <i>Why did the knees prevent me? or why
the breasts that I should suck?</i> | Why did the knees receive me? Or why
the breasts that I should nurse? |
| 13 | <i>For now should I have lain still and
been quiet, I should have slept: then
had I been at rest,</i> | For now I should have lain still and
been quiet; I should have slept; then I
would have been at rest, |

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| 14 | <i>With kings and counsellors of the earth, which built desolate places for themselves;</i> | with kings and counsellors of the earth, who built desolate places for themselves, |
| 15 | <i>Or with princes that had gold, who filled their houses with silver:</i> | or with princes who had gold, who filled their houses with silver. |
| 16 | <i>Or as an hidden untimely birth I had not been; as infants which never saw light.</i> | Or as a hidden untimely birth I had not been, as infants who never saw light. |
| 17 | <i>There the wicked cease from troubling; and there the weary be at rest.</i> | There the wicked cease from troubling, and there the weary are at rest. |
| 18 | <i>There the prisoners rest together; they hear not the voice of the oppressor.</i> | There the prisoners rest together; they do not hear the voice of the oppressor. |
| 19 | <i>The small and great are there; and the servant is free from his master.</i> | The small and great are there, and the servant is free from his master. |
| 20 | <i>Wherefore is light given to him that is in misery, and life unto the bitter in soul;</i> | Why is light given to him who is in misery, and life to the bitter in soul, |
| 21 | <i>Which long for death, but it cometh not; and dig for it more than for hid treasures;</i> | who long for death, but it does not come, and dig for it more than for hidden treasures, |
| 22 | <i>Which rejoice exceedingly, and are glad, when they can find the grave?</i> | who rejoice greatly and are glad when they can find the grave? |
| 23 | <i>Why is light given to a man whose way is hid, and whom God hath hedged in?</i> | Why is light given to a man whose way is hidden, and whom God has hedged in? |
| 24 | <i>For my sighing cometh before I eat, and my roarings are poured out like the waters.</i> | For my sighing comes before I eat, and my roarings are poured out like the waters. |
| 25 | <i>For the thing which I greatly feared is come upon me, and that which I was afraid of is come unto me.</i> | For the thing which I greatly feared has come on me, and that which I was afraid of has come to me. |

- 26 *I was not in safety, neither had I rest, neither was I quiet; yet trouble came.* I was not in safety, neither had I rest, neither was I quiet; yet trouble came."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 20:14-15
 v3 — Jer 20:14-18; Job 10:18-19; Jer 15:10
 v5 — Job 10:21-22; Job 28:3; Ps 23:4; Jer 2:6
 v8 — Job 41:1
 v16 — Ps 58:8
 v17 — Rev 14:13
 v20 — Jer 20:18
 v21 — Rev 9:6
 v23 — Job 19:8
 v24 — Ps 102:9
 v25 — Job 1:5; Job 30:15; Job 31:23

Chapter 4

Eliphaz begins his first speech, arguing that the innocent do not perish and that suffering comes from sin. He recounts a terrifying night vision in which a spirit declared that no mortal can be righteous before God.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>If we assay to commune with thee, wilt thou be grieved? but who can withhold himself from speaking?</i></p> <p>3 <i>Behold, thou hast instructed many, and thou hast strengthened the weak hands.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Thy words have upholden him that was falling, and thou hast strengthened the feeble knees.</i></p> <p>5 <i>But now it is come upon thee, and thou faintest; it toucheth thee, and thou art troubled.</i></p> | <p>Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered and said:</p> <p>"If we attempt to speak with you, will you be grieved? But who can withhold himself from speaking?</p> <p>See, you have instructed many, and you have strengthened the weak hands.</p> <p>Your words have upheld him that was falling, and you have strengthened the feeble knees.</p> <p>But now it has come on you, and you faint; it touches you, and you are troubled.</p> |
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- 6 *Is not this thy fear, thy confidence, thy hope, and the uprightness of thy ways?* Is not this your fear, your confidence, your hope, and the uprightness of your ways?
- 7 *Remember, I pray thee, who ever perished, being innocent? or where were the righteous cut off?* Remember, I pray you, who ever perished, being innocent? Or where were the righteous cut off?
- 8 *Even as I have seen, they that plow iniquity, and sow wickedness, reap the same.* Even as I have seen, they that plow iniquity, and sow wickedness, reap the same.
- 9 *By the blast of God they perish, and by the breath of his nostrils are they consumed.* By the blast of God they perish, and by the breath of his nostrils they are consumed.
- 10 *The roaring of the lion, and the voice of the fierce lion, and the teeth of the young lions, are broken.* The roaring of the lion, and the voice of the fierce lion, and the teeth of the young lions, are broken.
- 11 *The old lion perisheth for lack of prey, and the stout lion's whelps are scattered abroad.* The old lion perishes for lack of prey, and the stout lion's whelps are scattered abroad.
- 12 *Now a thing was secretly brought to me, and mine ear received a little thereof.* Now a thing was secretly brought to me, and my ear received a little of it.
- 13 *In thoughts from the visions of the night, when deep sleep falleth on men,* In thoughts from the visions of the night, when deep sleep falls on men,
- 14 *Fear came upon me, and trembling, which made all my bones to shake.* fear came on me, and trembling, which made all my bones to shake.
- 15 *Then a spirit passed before my face; the hair of my flesh stood up:* Then a spirit passed before my face; the hair of my flesh stood up.
- 16 *It stood still, but I could not discern the form thereof: an image was before mine eyes, there was silence, and I heard a voice, saying,* It stood still, but I could not discern the form of it: an image was before my eyes, there was silence, and I heard a voice, saying,
- 17 *Shall mortal man be more just than God? shall a man be more pure than his maker?* 'Shall mortal man be more just than God? Shall a man be more pure than his Maker?

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| 18 <i>Behold, he put no trust in his servants; and his angels he charged with folly:</i> | See, he put no trust in his servants, and his angels he charged with folly. |
| 19 <i>How much less in them that dwell in houses of clay, whose foundation is in the dust, which are crushed before the moth?</i> | How much less in them that live in houses of clay, whose foundation is in the dust, who are crushed before the moth? |
| 20 <i>They are destroyed from morning to evening: they perish for ever without any regarding it.</i> | They are destroyed from morning to evening; they perish forever without any regarding it. |
| 21 <i>Doth not their excellency which is in them go away? they die, even without wisdom.</i> | Does not their excellency which is in them go away? They die, even without wisdom.' |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Job 32:18-20
v3 — Isa 35:3
v6 — Prov 3:26; Prov 14:26; Job 1:1; Job 17:15; Job 23:11-12
v7 — Ps 37:25; 2 Pet 2:9; Job 36:7; Acts 28:4; Job 8:20
v8 — Gal 6:7-8; Prov 22:8; Hos 8:7; Job 15:35; 2 Cor 9:6
v9 — Job 15:30; Isa 30:33; 2 Thess 2:8; Isa 11:4; Rev 2:16
v10 — Ps 58:6
v11 — Ps 34:10
v17 — Job 9:2; Job 25:4; Eccl 7:20; Ps 143:2
v18 — Job 25:5-6; 2 Pet 2:4; Jude 1:6
v19 — Job 10:9; Gen 2:7; Gen 3:19
v21 — Job 36:12

Chapter 5

Eliphaz continues, insisting that affliction does not come from the dust but that man is born to trouble. He urges Job to seek God, who wounds but also binds up, and promises that the man whom God corrects will be blessed.

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| 1 <i>Call now, if there be any that will answer thee; and to which of the saints wilt thou turn?</i> | "Call now, if there is any that will answer you; and to which of the saints will you turn? |
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| 2 | <i>For wrath killeth the foolish man, and
envy slayeth the silly one.</i> | For wrath kills the foolish man, and
envy slays the silly one. |
| 3 | <i>I have seen the foolish taking root: but
suddenly I cursed his habitation.</i> | I have seen the foolish taking root, but
suddenly I cursed his habitation. |
| 4 | <i>His children are far from safety, and
they are crushed in the gate, neither is
there any to deliver them.</i> | His children are far from safety, and
they are crushed in the gate, neither is
there any to deliver them. |
| 5 | <i>Whose harvest the hungry eateth up,
and taketh it even out of the thorns,
and the robber swalloweth up their
substance.</i> | Whose harvest the hungry eats up, and
takes it even out of the thorns, and the
robber swallows up their substance. |
| 6 | <i>Although affliction cometh not forth of
the dust, neither doth trouble spring
out of the ground;</i> | Although affliction does not come
forth out of the dust, neither does
trouble spring out of the ground; |
| 7 | <i>Yet man is born unto trouble, as the
sparks fly upward.</i> | yet man is born to trouble, as the
sparks fly upward. |
| 8 | <i>I would seek unto God, and unto God
would I commit my cause:</i> | I would seek to God, and to God would
I commit my cause, |
| 9 | <i>Which doeth great things and
unsearchable; marvellous things
without number:</i> | who does great things and
unsearchable, marvellous things
without number, |
| 10 | <i>Who giveth rain upon the earth, and
sendeth waters upon the fields:</i> | who gives rain on the earth, and sends
waters on the fields, |
| 11 | <i>To set up on high those that be low;
that those which mourn may be
exalted to safety.</i> | to set up on high those that are low,
that those who mourn may be exalted
to safety. |
| 12 | <i>He disappointeth the devices of the
crafty, so that their hands cannot
perform their enterprise.</i> | He disappoints the devices of the
crafty, so that their hands cannot
perform their enterprise. |
| 13 | <i>He taketh the wise in their own
craftiness: and the counsel of the
froward is carried headlong.</i> | He takes the wise in their own
craftiness, and the counsel of the
perverse is carried headlong. |

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| 14 <i>They meet with darkness in the daytime, and grope in the noonday as in the night.</i> | They meet with darkness in the daytime, and grope in the noonday as in the night. |
| 15 <i>But he saveth the poor from the sword, from their mouth, and from the hand of the mighty.</i> | But he saves the poor from the sword, from their mouth, and from the hand of the mighty. |
| 16 <i>So the poor hath hope, and iniquity stoppeth her mouth.</i> | So the poor has hope, and iniquity stops her mouth. |
| 17 <i>Behold, happy is the man whom God correcteth: therefore despise not thou the chastening of the Almighty:</i> | Happy is the man whom God corrects; therefore do not despise the chastening of the Almighty. |
| 18 <i>For he maketh sore, and bindeth up: he woundeth, and his hands make whole.</i> | For He makes sore, and binds up; He wounds, and His hands make whole. |
| 19 <i>He shall deliver thee in six troubles: yea, in seven there shall no evil touch thee.</i> | He shall deliver You in six troubles; yes, in seven no evil shall touch You. |
| 20 <i>In famine he shall redeem thee from death: and in war from the power of the sword.</i> | In famine He shall redeem You from death, and in war from the power of the sword. |
| 21 <i>Thou shalt be hid from the scourge of the tongue: neither shalt thou be afraid of destruction when it cometh.</i> | You shall be hidden from the scourge of the tongue; neither shall You be afraid of destruction when it comes. |
| 22 <i>At destruction and famine thou shalt laugh: neither shalt thou be afraid of the beasts of the earth.</i> | At destruction and famine You shall laugh; neither shall You be afraid of the beasts of the earth. |
| 23 <i>For thou shalt be in league with the stones of the field: and the beasts of the field shall be at peace with thee.</i> | For You shall be in league with the stones of the field, and the beasts of the field shall be at peace with You. |
| 24 <i>And thou shalt know that thy tabernacle shall be in peace; and thou shalt visit thy habitation, and shalt not sin.</i> | You shall know that Your tabernacle shall be in peace; You shall visit Your habitation, and shall not sin. |

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| 25 | <i>Thou shalt know also that thy seed shall be great, and thine offspring as the grass of the earth.</i> | You shall know also that Your seed shall be great, and Your offspring as the grass of the earth. |
| 26 | <i>Thou shalt come to thy grave in a full age, like as a shock of corn cometh in in his season.</i> | You shall come to Your grave in a full age, like as a shock of grain comes in its season. |
| 27 | <i>Lo this, we have searched it, so it is; hear it, and know thou it for thy good.</i> | This we have searched out, so it is; hear it, and know it for Your good." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v8 — Ps 50:15; Ps 37:5; Job 22:21; 2 Chr 33:12-13; 1 Pet 4:19
v9 — Ps 40:5; Job 9:10; Ps 86:10; Ps 72:18; Job 11:7-9
v12 — Ps 21:11; Ps 33:10-11; Isa 8:10; Prov 21:30; Ps 37:17
v13 — 1 Cor 3:19; Ps 9:15-16; 1 Cor 1:19-20; Luke 1:51; Ps 7:15-16
v17 — Jas 1:12; Ps 94:12; Prov 3:11-12; Rev 3:19; Jas 5:11
v18 — Hos 6:1; Deut 32:39; Isa 30:26; Ps 147:3; 1 Sam 2:6
v19 — Ps 34:19; 1 Cor 10:13; Ps 91:3-10; Prov 24:16; 2 Pet 2:9
v20 — Ps 33:19; Hos 13:14; 1 Kgs 17:6; Gen 45:7; Ps 37:19
v21 — Ps 31:20; Ps 91:5-7; Prov 12:18; Jer 18:18; Jas 3:5-8
v23 — Lev 26:6; Dan 6:22; Ps 91:12-13; Isa 11:6-9; Hos 2:18
v25 — Ps 112:2; Ps 72:16; Deut 28:4; Job 42:13-16; Gen 15:5
v26 — Prov 9:11; Job 42:16-17; Ps 91:16; Gen 15:15; Prov 10:27

Chapter 6

Job replies to Eliphaz, declaring that his grief is heavier than the sand of the sea. He wishes God would crush him and end his life, and rebukes his friends as unreliable as a dried-up brook.

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| 1 | <i>But Job answered and said,</i> | But Job answered and said: |
| 2 | <i>Oh that my grief were thoroughly weighed, and my calamity laid in the balances together!</i> | "Oh that my grief were thoroughly weighed, and my calamity laid in the balances together! |
| 3 | <i>For now it would be heavier than the sand of the sea: therefore my words are swallowed up.</i> | For now it would be heavier than the sand of the sea; therefore my words are swallowed up. |

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| <p>4 <i>For the arrows of the Almighty are within me, the poison whereof drinketh up my spirit: the terrors of God do set themselves in array against me.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Doth the wild ass bray when he hath grass? or loweth the ox over his fodder?</i></p> <p>6 <i>Can that which is unsavoury be eaten without salt? or is there any taste in the white of an egg?</i></p> <p>7 <i>The things that my soul refused to touch are as my sorrowful meat.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Oh that I might have my request; and that God would grant me the thing that I long for!</i></p> <p>9 <i>Even that it would please God to destroy me; that he would let loose his hand, and cut me off!</i></p> <p>10 <i>Then should I yet have comfort; yea, I would harden myself in sorrow: let him not spare; for I have not concealed the words of the Holy One.</i></p> <p>11 <i>What is my strength, that I should hope? and what is mine end, that I should prolong my life?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Is my strength the strength of stones? or is my flesh of brass?</i></p> <p>13 <i>Is not my help in me? and is wisdom driven quite from me?</i></p> <p>14 <i>To him that is afflicted pity should be shewed from his friend; but he forsaketh the fear of the Almighty.</i></p> | <p>For the arrows of the Almighty are within me, the poison of which drinks up my spirit; the terrors of God set themselves in array against me.</p> <p>Does the wild ass bray when He has grass? Or lows the ox over His fodder?</p> <p>Can that which is unsavoury be eaten without salt? Or is there any taste in the white of an egg?</p> <p>The things that my soul refused to touch are as my sorrowful meat.</p> <p>Oh that I might have my request, and that God would grant me the thing that I long for!</p> <p>Even that it would please God to destroy me, that He would let loose His hand and cut me off!</p> <p>Then I would yet have comfort; yes, I would harden myself in sorrow: let Him not spare; for I have not concealed the words of the Holy One.</p> <p>What is my strength, that I should hope? And what is my end, that I should prolong my life?</p> <p>Is my strength the strength of stones? Or is my flesh of brass?</p> <p>Is not my help in me? And is wisdom driven quite from me?</p> <p>To Him that is afflicted pity should be shown from His friend; but He forsakes the fear of the Almighty.</p> |
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- 15 *My brethren have dealt deceitfully as a brook, and as the stream of brooks they pass away;* My brethren have dealt deceitfully as a brook, and as the stream of brooks they pass away,
- 16 *Which are blackish by reason of the ice, and wherein the snow is hid:* which are blackish by reason of the ice, and in which the snow is hid;
- 17 *What time they wax warm, they vanish: when it is hot, they are consumed out of their place.* what time they grow warm, they vanish; when it is hot, they are consumed out of their place.
- 18 *The paths of their way are turned aside; they go to nothing, and perish.* The paths of their way are turned aside; they go to nothing, and perish.
- 19 *The troops of Tema looked, the companies of Sheba waited for them.* The troops of Tema looked, the companies of Sheba waited for them.
- 20 *They were confounded because they had hoped; they came thither, and were ashamed.* They were confounded because they had hoped; they came there, and were ashamed.
- 21 *For now ye are nothing; ye see my casting down, and are afraid.* For now You are nothing; You see my casting down, and are afraid.
- 22 *Did I say, Bring unto me? or, Give a reward for me of your substance?* Did I say, 'Bring to me'? Or, 'Give a reward for me of Your substance'?
- 23 *Or, Deliver me from the enemy's hand? or, Redeem me from the hand of the mighty?* Or, 'Deliver me from the enemy's hand'? Or, 'Redeem me from the hand of the mighty'?
- 24 *Teach me, and I will hold my tongue: and cause me to understand wherein I have erred.* Teach me, and I will hold my tongue; and cause me to understand in what I have erred.
- 25 *How forcible are right words! but what doth your arguing reprove?* How forcible are right words! But what does Your arguing reprove?
- 26 *Do ye imagine to reprove words, and the speeches of one that is desperate, which are as wind?* Do You imagine to reprove words, and the speeches of one that is desperate, which are as wind?
- 27 *Yea, ye overwhelm the fatherless, and ye dig a pit for your friend.* Yes, You overwhelm the fatherless, and You dig a pit for Your friend.

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| <p>28 <i>Now therefore be content, look upon me; for it is evident unto you if I lie.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Return, I pray you, let it not be iniquity; yea, return again, my righteousness is in it.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Is there iniquity in my tongue? cannot my taste discern perverse things?</i></p> | <p>Now therefore be content, look on me; for it is evident to You if I lie.</p> <p>Return, I pray You, let it not be iniquity; yes, return again, my righteousness is in it.</p> <p>Is there iniquity in my tongue? Cannot my taste discern perverse things?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Prov 27:3
v4 — Ps 38:2; Job 30:15; Ps 88:15-16; Prov 18:14
v8 — Ps 119:81
v9 — 1 Kgs 19:4; Jonah 4:3
v10 — Job 23:12
v11 — Ps 103:14-16
v14 — Prov 17:17; Gal 6:2; 1 Cor 12:26
v15 — Ps 38:11; Jer 15:18
v19 — Isa 21:14; Gen 25:15
v21 — Ps 38:11
v24 — Jas 3:2; Prov 9:9
v30 — Job 12:11

Chapter 7

Job laments the brevity and misery of human life, comparing man's days to those of a hireling. He turns his complaint toward God, asking why God watches him so closely and will not leave him alone even long enough to swallow his spit.

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| <p>1 <i>Is there not an appointed time to man upon earth? are not his days also like the days of an hireling?</i></p> <p>2 <i>As a servant earnestly desireth the shadow, and as an hireling looketh for the reward of his work:</i></p> <p>3 <i>So am I made to possess months of vanity, and wearisome nights are appointed to me.</i></p> | <p>"Is there not an appointed time to man on earth? Are not his days also like the days of a hireling?</p> <p>As a servant earnestly desires the shadow, and as a hireling looks for the reward of his work,</p> <p>so am I made to possess months of vanity, and wearisome nights are appointed to me.</p> |
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| 4 <i>When I lie down, I say, When shall I arise, and the night be gone? and I am full of tossings to and fro unto the dawning of the day.</i> | When I lie down, I say, 'When shall I arise, and the night be gone?' And I am full of tossings to and fro until the dawning of the day. |
| 5 <i>My flesh is clothed with worms and clods of dust; my skin is broken, and become loathsome.</i> | My flesh is clothed with worms and clods of dust; my skin is broken, and become loathsome. |
| 6 <i>My days are swifter than a weaver's shuttle, and are spent without hope.</i> | My days are swifter than a weaver's shuttle, and are spent without hope. |
| 7 <i>O remember that my life is wind: mine eye shall no more see good.</i> | O remember that my life is wind; my eye shall no more see good. |
| 8 <i>The eye of him that hath seen me shall see me no more: thine eyes are upon me, and I am not.</i> | The eye of him that has seen me shall see me no more; your eyes are on me, and I am not. |
| 9 <i>As the cloud is consumed and vanisheth away: so he that goeth down to the grave shall come up no more.</i> | As the cloud is consumed and vanishes away, so he that goes down to the grave shall come up no more. |
| 10 <i>He shall return no more to his house, neither shall his place know him any more.</i> | He shall return no more to his house, neither shall his place know him any more. |
| 11 <i>Therefore I will not refrain my mouth; I will speak in the anguish of my spirit; I will complain in the bitterness of my soul.</i> | Therefore I will not refrain my mouth; I will speak in the anguish of my spirit; I will complain in the bitterness of my soul. |
| 12 <i>Am I a sea, or a whale, that thou settest a watch over me?</i> | Am I a sea, or a whale, that you set a watch over me? |
| 13 <i>When I say, My bed shall comfort me, my couch shall ease my complaint;</i> | When I say, 'My bed shall comfort me, my couch shall ease my complaint,' |
| 14 <i>Then thou scarest me with dreams, and terrifiest me through visions:</i> | then you scare me with dreams, and terrify me through visions, |
| 15 <i>So that my soul chooseth strangling, and death rather than my life.</i> | so that my soul chooses strangling, and death rather than my life. |

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| <p>16 <i>I loathe it; I would not live alway: let me alone; for my days are vanity.</i></p> <p>17 <i>What is man, that thou shouldest magnify him? and that thou shouldest set thine heart upon him?</i></p> <p>18 <i>And that thou shouldest visit him every morning, and try him every moment?</i></p> <p>19 <i>How long wilt thou not depart from me, nor let me alone till I swallow down my spittle?</i></p> <p>20 <i>I have sinned; what shall I do unto thee, O thou preserver of men? why hast thou set me as a mark against thee, so that I am a burden to myself?</i></p> <p>21 <i>And why dost thou not pardon my transgression, and take away mine iniquity? for now shall I sleep in the dust; and thou shalt seek me in the morning, but I shall not be.</i></p> | <p>I loathe it; I would not live always; let me alone, for my days are vanity.</p> <p>What is man, that you should magnify him? And that you should set your heart on him?</p> <p>And that you should visit him every morning, and try him every moment?</p> <p>How long will you not depart from me, nor let me alone till I swallow down my spittle?</p> <p>I have sinned; what shall I do to you, O preserver of men? Why have you set me as a mark against you, so that I am a burden to myself?</p> <p>And why do you not pardon my transgression, and take away my iniquity? For now shall I sleep in the dust; and you shall seek me in the morning, but I shall not be."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 14:5-6; Ps 39:4; Job 5:7; Job 14:13-14
- v2 — Lev 19:13
- v3 — Ps 6:6
- v4 — Deut 28:67; Job 7:13-14
- v5 — Job 17:14; Isa 14:11
- v6 — Job 9:25; Job 17:15; Job 17:11
- v7 — Jas 4:14; Ps 78:39
- v8 — Job 20:9
- v11 — 1 Sam 1:10; Ps 40:9; Job 10:1; Isa 38:17; Job 6:26
- v16 — Job 10:1; 1 Kgs 19:4
- v17 — Heb 2:6; Ps 8:4; Ps 144:3; Job 34:14-15
- v20 — Lam 3:12

Chapter 8

Bildad begins his first speech, insisting that God does not pervert justice. He suggests Job's children died for their own sin and urges Job to seek God, promising that the Almighty will restore the righteous but destroy the hypocrite.

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| 1 <i>Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,</i> | Then Bildad the Shuhite answered and said: |
| 2 <i>How long wilt thou speak these things? and how long shall the words of thy mouth be like a strong wind?</i> | "How long will You speak these things? And how long shall the words of Your mouth be like a strong wind? |
| 3 <i>Doth God pervert judgment? or doth the Almighty pervert justice?</i> | Does God pervert judgment? Or does the Almighty pervert justice? |
| 4 <i>If thy children have sinned against him, and he have cast them away for their transgression;</i> | If Your children have sinned against Him, and He has cast them away for their transgression; |
| 5 <i>If thou wouldest seek unto God betimes, and make thy supplication to the Almighty;</i> | if You would seek to God in good time, and make Your supplication to the Almighty; |
| 6 <i>If thou wert pure and upright; surely now he would awake for thee, and make the habitation of thy righteousness prosperous.</i> | if You were pure and upright, surely now He would awake for You, and make the habitation of Your righteousness prosperous. |
| 7 <i>Though thy beginning was small, yet thy latter end should greatly increase.</i> | Though Your beginning was small, yet Your latter end should greatly increase. |
| 8 <i>For enquire, I pray thee, of the former age, and prepare thyself to the search of their fathers:</i> | For inquire, I pray You, of the former age, and prepare Yourself to the search of their fathers, |
| 9 <i>(For we are but of yesterday, and know nothing, because our days upon earth are a shadow:)</i> | (for we are but of yesterday, and know nothing, because our days on earth are a shadow), |
| 10 <i>Shall not they teach thee, and tell thee, and utter words out of their heart?</i> | shall they not teach You, and tell You, and utter words out of their heart? |
| 11 <i>Can the rush grow up without mire? can the flag grow without water?</i> | Can the rush grow up without mire?
Can the flag grow without water? |

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| <p>12 <i>Whilst it is yet in his greenness, and not cut down, it withereth before any other herb.</i></p> <p>13 <i>So are the paths of all that forget God; and the hypocrite's hope shall perish:</i></p> <p>14 <i>Whose hope shall be cut off, and whose trust shall be a spider's web.</i></p> <p>15 <i>He shall lean upon his house, but it shall not stand: he shall hold it fast, but it shall not endure.</i></p> <p>16 <i>He is green before the sun, and his branch shooteth forth in his garden.</i></p> <p>17 <i>His roots are wrapped about the heap, and seeth the place of stones.</i></p> <p>18 <i>If he destroy him from his place, then it shall deny him, saying, I have not seen thee.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Behold, this is the joy of his way, and out of the earth shall others grow.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Behold, God will not cast away a perfect man, neither will he help the evil doers:</i></p> <p>21 <i>Till he fill thy mouth with laughing, and thy lips with rejoicing.</i></p> <p>22 <i>They that hate thee shall be clothed with shame; and the dwelling place of the wicked shall come to nought.</i></p> | <p>While it is yet in its greenness, and not cut down, it withers before any other herb.</p> <p>So are the paths of all that forget God; and the hypocrite's hope shall perish,</p> <p>whose hope shall be cut off, and whose trust shall be a spider's web.</p> <p>He shall lean on His house, but it shall not stand; He shall hold it fast, but it shall not endure.</p> <p>He is green before the sun, and His branch shoots forth in His garden.</p> <p>His roots are wrapped about the heap, and sees the place of stones.</p> <p>If He destroy Him from His place, then it shall deny Him, saying, 'I have not seen You.'</p> <p>See, this is the joy of His way, and out of the earth shall others grow.</p> <p>See, God will not cast away a perfect man, neither will He help the evildoers,</p> <p>till He fill Your mouth with laughing, and Your lips with rejoicing.</p> <p>They that hate you shall be clothed with shame, and the dwelling place of the wicked shall come to nothing."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Job 2:11

v3 — Deut 32:4; 2 Chr 19:7; Gen 18:25

- v4 — Job 1:5
 v5 — Jas 4:7-10; Job 11:13; Heb 3:7-8; Isa 55:6-7; Matt 7:7-8
 v6 — Isa 51:9; Isa 3:10; Job 5:24; Prov 15:8; Ps 7:6
 v7 — Job 42:12-13; Matt 13:31-32; Prov 19:20; Prov 4:18; Zech 4:10
 v8 — Job 15:18; Deut 32:7; Deut 4:32; Rom 15:4
 v9 — 1 Chr 29:15; Ps 144:4; Job 14:2; Ps 102:11
 v13 — Ps 9:17; Job 13:16; Job 11:20; Prov 10:28; Job 15:34
 v20 — Job 4:7; Ps 37:37; Ps 37:24; Isa 45:1; Ps 94:14
 v21 — Ps 126:2; Gen 21:6; Ps 126:6; Ps 32:11; Luke 6:21
 v22 — Ps 132:18; Ps 109:29; Ps 35:26; Job 18:14; Job 8:18

Chapter 9

Job answers Bildad and acknowledges that no mortal can be righteous before God. He describes God's overwhelming power over creation and longs for an arbiter to stand between them, since he cannot contend with the Almighty in judgment.

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| 1 | <i>Then Job answered and said,</i> | Then Job answered and said: |
| 2 | <i>I know it is so of a truth: but how should man be just with God?</i> | "I know it is so in truth; but how should man be just with God? |
| 3 | <i>If he will contend with him, he cannot answer him one of a thousand.</i> | If he will contend with him, he cannot answer him one of a thousand. |
| 4 | <i>He is wise in heart, and mighty in strength: who hath hardened himself against him, and hath prospered?</i> | He is wise in heart, and mighty in strength; who has hardened himself against him, and has prospered? |
| 5 | <i>Which removeth the mountains, and they know not: which overturneth them in his anger.</i> | He removes the mountains, and they know it not; he overturns them in his anger. |
| 6 | <i>Which shaketh the earth out of her place, and the pillars thereof tremble.</i> | He shakes the earth out of her place, and the pillars of it tremble. |
| 7 | <i>Which commandeth the sun, and it riseth not; and sealeth up the stars.</i> | He commands the sun, and it rises not; and seals up the stars. |
| 8 | <i>Which alone spreadeth out the heavens, and treadeth upon the waves of the sea.</i> | He alone spreads out the heavens, and treads on the waves of the sea. |
| 9 | <i>Which maketh Arcturus, Orion, and Pleiades, and the chambers of the south.</i> | He makes Arcturus, Orion, and Pleiades, and the chambers of the south. |

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| <p>10 <i>Which doeth great things past finding out; yea, and wonders without number.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Lo, he goeth by me, and I see him not: he passeth on also, but I perceive him not.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Behold, he taketh away, who can hinder him? who will say unto him, What doest thou?</i></p> <p>13 <i>If God will not withdraw his anger, the proud helpers do stoop under him.</i></p> <p>14 <i>How much less shall I answer him, and choose out my words to reason with him?</i></p> <p>15 <i>Whom, though I were righteous, yet would I not answer, but I would make supplication to my judge.</i></p> <p>16 <i>If I had called, and he had answered me; yet would I not believe that he had hearkened unto my voice.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For he breaketh me with a tempest, and multiplieth my wounds without cause.</i></p> <p>18 <i>He will not suffer me to take my breath, but filleth me with bitterness.</i></p> <p>19 <i>If I speak of strength, lo, he is strong: and if of judgment, who shall set me a time to plead?</i></p> <p>20 <i>If I justify myself, mine own mouth shall condemn me: if I say, I am perfect, it shall also prove me perverse.</i></p> | <p>He does great things past finding out; yes, and wonders without number.</p> <p>He goes by me, and I do not see him; he passes on also, but I do not see him.</p> <p>See, he takes away, who can hinder him? Who will say to him, 'What are you doing?'</p> <p>If God will not withdraw His anger, the proud helpers stoop under Him.</p> <p>How much less shall I answer him, and choose out my words to reason with him?</p> <p>Whom, though I were righteous, yet would I not answer, but I would make supplication to my judge.</p> <p>If I had called, and he had answered me, yet would I not believe that he had listened to my voice.</p> <p>For he breaks me with a tempest, and multiplies my wounds without cause.</p> <p>He will not allow me to take my breath, but fills me with bitterness.</p> <p>If I speak of strength, he is strong; and if of judgment, who shall set me a time to plead?</p> <p>If I justify myself, my own mouth shall condemn me; if I say, 'I am perfect,' it shall also prove me perverse.</p> |
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- 21 *Though I were perfect, yet would I not know my soul: I would despise my life.* Though I were perfect, yet would I not know my soul; I would despise my life.
- 22 *This is one thing, therefore I said it, He destroyeth the perfect and the wicked.* This is one thing, therefore I said it: He destroys the perfect and the wicked.
- 23 *If the scourge slay suddenly, he will laugh at the trial of the innocent.* If the scourge slay suddenly, he will laugh at the trial of the innocent.
- 24 *The earth is given into the hand of the wicked: he covereth the faces of the judges thereof; if not, where, and who is he?* The earth is given into the hand of the wicked; he covers the faces of the judges of it. If it is not he, where, and who is he?
- 25 *Now my days are swifter than a post: they flee away, they see no good.* Now my days are swifter than a runner; they flee away, they see no good.
- 26 *They are passed away as the swift ships: as the eagle that hasteth to the prey.* They are passed away as the swift ships, as the eagle that hastens to the prey.
- 27 *If I say, I will forget my complaint, I will leave off my heaviness, and comfort myself:* If I say, 'I will forget my complaint, I will leave off my heaviness, and comfort myself,'
- 28 *I am afraid of all my sorrows, I know that thou wilt not hold me innocent.* I am afraid of all my sorrows; I know that you will not hold me innocent.
- 29 *If I be wicked, why then labour I in vain?* If I be wicked, why then do I labour in vain?
- 30 *If I wash myself with snow water, and make my hands never so clean;* If I wash myself with snow water, and make my hands never so clean,
- 31 *Yet shalt thou plunge me in the ditch, and mine own clothes shall abhor me.* yet shall you plunge me in the ditch, and my own clothes shall abhor me.
- 32 *For he is not a man, as I am, that I should answer him, and we should come together in judgment.* For he is not a man, as I am, that I should answer him, and we should come together in judgment.

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| 33 | <i>Neither is there any daysman betwixt us, that might lay his hand upon us both.</i> | Neither is there any daysman between us, that might lay his hand on us both. |
| 34 | <i>Let him take his rod away from me, and let not his fear terrify me:</i> | Let him take his rod away from me, and let not his fear terrify me. |
| 35 | <i>Then would I speak, and not fear him; but it is not so with me.</i> | Then would I speak, and not fear him; but it is not so with me." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Job 4:17; Ps 143:2; Rom 3:20; Job 25:4
v6 — Ps 75:3; Hag 2:6; Heb 12:26; Job 26:11; Isa 2:21
v8 — Isa 44:24; Isa 40:22; Ps 104:2-3; Job 37:18; Zech 12:1
v9 — Amos 5:8; Gen 1:16; Job 38:31-41
v10 — Job 5:9; Ps 72:18; Eph 3:20; Rom 11:33; Ps 136:4
v11 — Job 23:8-9; Job 35:14; Ps 77:19; 1 Tim 6:16
v12 — Job 11:10; Isa 45:9; Job 23:13
v13 — Job 26:12; Ps 89:10; Isa 51:9; Isa 30:7; Jas 4:6-7
v15 — Job 10:15; Job 8:5
v19 — Job 9:4; Job 9:32-33; 1 Cor 1:25; Matt 6:13; Ps 62:11
v32 — Rom 9:20; Eccl 6:10
v33 — 1 Sam 2:25; 1 John 2:1-2; Job 9:19

Chapter 10

Job continues his reply, pouring out his complaint directly to God. He asks why God contends with him, reminds God that He formed him from clay, and pleads to be left alone before he goes to the land of darkness.

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| 1 | <i>My soul is weary of my life; I will leave my complaint upon myself; I will speak in the bitterness of my soul.</i> | "My soul is weary of my life; I will leave my complaint on myself; I will speak in the bitterness of my soul. |
| 2 | <i>I will say unto God, Do not condemn me; shew me wherefore thou contendest with me.</i> | I will say to God, 'Do not condemn me; show me why you contend with me. |

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| 3 | <i>Is it good unto thee that thou shouldst oppress, that thou shouldst despise the work of thine hands, and shine upon the counsel of the wicked?</i> | Is it good to you that you should oppress, that you should despise the work of your hands, and shine on the counsel of the wicked? |
| 4 | <i>Hast thou eyes of flesh? or seest thou as man seeth?</i> | Have you eyes of flesh? Or do you see as man sees? |
| 5 | <i>Are thy days as the days of man? are thy years as man's days,</i> | Are your days as the days of man? Are your years as man's days, |
| 6 | <i>That thou enquirest after mine iniquity, and searchest after my sin?</i> | that you inquire after my iniquity, and search after my sin? |
| 7 | <i>Thou knowest that I am not wicked; and there is none that can deliver out of thine hand.</i> | You know that I am not wicked; and there is none that can deliver out of your hand. |
| 8 | <i>Thine hands have made me and fashioned me together round about; yet thou dost destroy me.</i> | Your hands have made me and fashioned me together round about; yet you do destroy me. |
| 9 | <i>Remember, I beseech thee, that thou hast made me as the clay; and wilt thou bring me into dust again?</i> | Remember, I beseech you, that you have made me as the clay; and will you bring me into dust again? |
| 10 | <i>Hast thou not poured me out as milk, and curdled me like cheese?</i> | Have you not poured me out as milk, and curdled me like cheese? |
| 11 | <i>Thou hast clothed me with skin and flesh, and hast fenced me with bones and sinews.</i> | You have clothed me with skin and flesh, and have fenced me with bones and sinews. |
| 12 | <i>Thou hast granted me life and favour, and thy visitation hath preserved my spirit.</i> | You have granted me life and favour, and your visitation has preserved my spirit. |
| 13 | <i>And these things hast thou hid in thine heart: I know that this is with thee.</i> | And these things you have hidden in your heart; I know that this is with you. |
| 14 | <i>If I sin, then thou markest me, and thou wilt not acquit me from mine iniquity.</i> | If I sin, then you mark me, and you will not acquit me from my iniquity. |

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| <p>15 <i>If I be wicked, woe unto me; and if I be righteous, yet will I not lift up my head. I am full of confusion; therefore see thou mine affliction;</i></p> <p>16 <i>For it increaseth. Thou huntest me as a fierce lion: and again thou shewest thyself marvellous upon me.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Thou renewest thy witnesses against me, and increasest thine indignation upon me; changes and war are against me.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Wherefore then hast thou brought me forth out of the womb? Oh that I had given up the ghost, and no eye had seen me!</i></p> <p>19 <i>I should have been as though I had not been; I should have been carried from the womb to the grave.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Are not my days few? cease then, and let me alone, that I may take comfort a little,</i></p> <p>21 <i>Before I go whence I shall not return, even to the land of darkness and the shadow of death;</i></p> <p>22 <i>A land of darkness, as darkness itself; and of the shadow of death, without any order, and where the light is as darkness.</i></p> | <p>If I be wicked, woe to me; and if I be righteous, yet will I not lift up my head. I am full of confusion; therefore see my affliction;</p> <p>for it increases. You hunt me as a fierce lion, and again you show yourself marvellous on me.</p> <p>You renew your witnesses against me, and increase your indignation on me; changes and war are against me.</p> <p>Why then have you brought me forth out of the womb? Oh that I had given up the ghost, and no eye had seen me!</p> <p>I should have been as though I had not been; I should have been carried from the womb to the grave.</p> <p>Are not my days few? Cease then, and let me alone, that I may take comfort a little,</p> <p>before I go from where I shall not return, even to the land of darkness and the shadow of death,</p> <p>a land of darkness, as darkness itself; and of the shadow of death, without any order, and where the light is as darkness.' "</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Job 7:11; 1 Kgs 19:4; Num 11:15

v2 — Ps 139:23-24

v3 — Isa 64:8; Ps 138:8; Job 14:15

- v4 — 1 Sam 16:7
 v5 — 2 Pet 3:8
 v8 — Ps 119:73; Job 10:3; Isa 43:7; Jer 18:3-10
 v9 — Gen 2:7; Isa 64:8; Gen 3:19; Eccl 12:7
 v12 — Acts 17:28; Job 33:4; Acts 17:25
 v15 — Isa 3:11; Job 9:15; Job 9:20-21
 v17 — Job 16:8; Ruth 1:21
 v20 — Job 14:1; Ps 39:13
 v21 — Job 3:5; 2 Sam 12:23; Job 16:22

Chapter 11

Zophar begins his first speech, rebuking Job for his many words and insisting that God is exacting less punishment than Job's iniquity deserves. He declares that the wisdom of God is higher than heaven and deeper than hell, and urges Job to repent.

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| 1 | <i>Then answered Zophar the Naamathite, and said,</i> | Then Zophar the Naamathite answered and said: |
| 2 | <i>Should not the multitude of words be answered? and should a man full of talk be justified?</i> | "Should not the multitude of words be answered? And should a man full of talk be justified? |
| 3 | <i>Should thy lies make men hold their peace? and when thou mockest, shall no man make thee ashamed?</i> | Should your lies make men hold their peace? And when you mock, shall no man make you ashamed? |
| 4 | <i>For thou hast said, My doctrine is pure, and I am clean in thine eyes.</i> | For you have said, 'My doctrine is pure, and I am clean in your eyes.' |
| 5 | <i>But oh that God would speak, and open his lips against thee;</i> | But oh that God would speak, and open His lips against you, |
| 6 | <i>And that he would shew thee the secrets of wisdom, that they are double to that which is! Know therefore that God exacteth of thee less than thine iniquity deserveth.</i> | and that he would show you the secrets of wisdom, that they are double to that which is! Know therefore that God exacts of you less than your iniquity deserves. |
| 7 | <i>Canst thou by searching find out God? canst thou find out the Almighty unto perfection?</i> | Can You by searching find out God? Can You find out the Almighty to perfection? |

- 8 *It is as high as heaven; what canst thou do? deeper than hell; what canst thou know?* It is as high as heaven; what can You do? Deeper than hell; what can You know?
- 9 *The measure thereof is longer than the earth, and broader than the sea.* The measure of it is longer than the earth, and broader than the sea.
- 10 *If he cut off, and shut up, or gather together, then who can hinder him?* If He cut off, and shut up, or gather together, then who can hinder Him?
- 11 *For he knoweth vain men: he seeth wickedness also; will he not then consider it?* For He knows vain men; He sees wickedness also; will He not then consider it?
- 12 *For vain man would be wise, though man be born like a wild ass's colt.* For vain man would be wise, though man be born like a wild ass's colt.
- 13 *If thou prepare thine heart, and stretch out thine hands toward him;* If You prepare Your heart, and stretch out Your hands toward Him;
- 14 *If iniquity be in thine hand, put it far away, and let not wickedness dwell in thy tabernacles.* if iniquity be in Your hand, put it far away, and let not wickedness dwell in Your tabernacles.
- 15 *For then shalt thou lift up thy face without spot; yea, thou shalt be stedfast, and shalt not fear:* For then shall You lift up Your face without spot; yes, You shall be stedfast, and shall not fear.
- 16 *Because thou shalt forget thy misery, and remember it as waters that pass away:* Because You shall forget Your misery, and remember it as waters that pass away.
- 17 *And thine age shall be clearer than the noonday; thou shalt shine forth, thou shalt be as the morning.* And Your age shall be clearer than the noonday; You shall shine forth, You shall be as the morning.
- 18 *And thou shalt be secure, because there is hope; yea, thou shalt dig about thee, and thou shalt take thy rest in safety.* And You shall be secure, because there is hope; yes, You shall dig about You, and You shall take Your rest in safety.
- 19 *Also thou shalt lie down, and none shall make thee afraid; yea, many shall make suit unto thee.* Also You shall lie down, and none shall make You afraid; yes, many shall make suit to You.

- 20 *But the eyes of the wicked shall fail, and they shall not escape, and their hope shall be as the giving up of the ghost.* But the eyes of the wicked shall fail, and they shall not escape, and their hope shall be as the giving up of the ghost."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Job 17:2
 v4 — Job 10:7
 v6 — Ezra 9:13; Lam 3:22; Eph 3:5; Matt 13:35; Dan 2:28
 v7 — Rom 11:33; Eccl 3:11; Ps 145:3
 v11 — Heb 4:13; Ps 10:14; Rev 2:23
 v13 — Ps 143:6; Ps 88:9; Ps 78:8; 1 Sam 7:3; Job 8:5-6
 v14 — Job 22:23
 v15 — Job 22:26
 v16 — Isa 65:16; Eccl 5:20; John 16:21; Isa 54:9; Isa 54:4
 v17 — Isa 58:8-10; Ps 37:6; Prov 4:18; Zech 14:6-7; Hos 6:3
 v18 — Prov 3:24-26; Ps 3:5; Ps 43:5; Ps 4:8; Lev 26:5-6
 v19 — Isa 60:14; Ps 45:12; Lev 26:6; Isa 45:14

Chapter 12

Job responds with biting sarcasm, telling his friends that wisdom will die with them. He declares that even the beasts know God's hand governs all things, and describes God's sovereign power to tear down nations, expose counsellors, and overthrow the mighty.

- 1 *And Job answered and said,* And Job answered and said:
 2 *No doubt but ye are the people, and wisdom shall die with you.* "No doubt but you are the people, and wisdom shall die with you.
 3 *But I have understanding as well as you; I am not inferior to you: yea, who knoweth not such things as these?* But I have understanding as well as you; I am not inferior to you. Yes, who does not know such things as these?
 4 *I am as one mocked of his neighbour, who calleth upon God, and he answereth him: the just upright man is laughed to scorn.* I am as one mocked of his neighbour, who calls on God, and He answers Him; the just upright man is laughed to scorn.

- 5 *He that is ready to slip with his feet is as a lamp despised in the thought of him that is at ease.* He that is ready to slip with his feet is as a lamp despised in the thought of him that is at ease.
- 6 *The tabernacles of robbers prosper, and they that provoke God are secure; into whose hand God bringeth abundantly.* The tabernacles of robbers prosper, and they that provoke God are secure, into whose hand God brings abundantly.
- 7 *But ask now the beasts, and they shall teach thee; and the fowls of the air, and they shall tell thee:* But ask now the beasts, and they shall teach you; and the fowls of the air, and they shall tell you.
- 8 *Or speak to the earth, and it shall teach thee: and the fishes of the sea shall declare unto thee.* Or speak to the earth, and it shall teach you; and the fishes of the sea shall declare to you.
- 9 *Who knoweth not in all these that the hand of the LORD hath wrought this?* Who does not know in all these that the hand of the LORD has wrought this?
- 10 *In whose hand is the soul of every living thing, and the breath of all mankind.* In whose hand is the soul of every living thing, and the breath of all mankind.
- 11 *Doth not the ear try words? and the mouth taste his meat?* Does not the ear try words? And the mouth taste its meat?
- 12 *With the ancient is wisdom; and in length of days understanding.* With the ancient is wisdom; and in length of days understanding.
- 13 *With him is wisdom and strength, he hath counsel and understanding.* With Him is wisdom and strength; He has counsel and understanding.
- 14 *Behold, he breaketh down, and it cannot be built again: he shutteth up a man, and there can be no opening.* See, He breaks down, and it cannot be built again; He shuts up a man, and there can be no opening.
- 15 *Behold, he withholdeth the waters, and they dry up: also he sendeth them out, and they overturn the earth.* See, He withholds the waters, and they dry up; also He sends them out, and they overturn the earth.
- 16 *With him is strength and wisdom: the deceived and the deceiver are his.* With Him is strength and wisdom; the deceived and the deceiver are His.

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| 17 <i>He leadeth counsellors away spoiled, and maketh the judges fools.</i> | He leads counsellors away spoiled, and makes the judges fools. |
| 18 <i>He looseth the bond of kings, and girdeth their loins with a girdle.</i> | He looses the bond of kings, and girds their loins with a girdle. |
| 19 <i>He leadeth princes away spoiled, and overthroweth the mighty.</i> | He leads princes away spoiled, and overthrows the mighty. |
| 20 <i>He removeth away the speech of the trusty, and taketh away the understanding of the aged.</i> | He removes away the speech of the trusty, and takes away the understanding of the aged. |
| 21 <i>He poureth contempt upon princes, and weakeneth the strength of the mighty.</i> | He pours contempt on princes, and weakens the strength of the mighty. |
| 22 <i>He discovereth deep things out of darkness, and bringeth out to light the shadow of death.</i> | He discovers deep things out of darkness, and brings out to light the shadow of death. |
| 23 <i>He increaseth the nations, and destroyeth them: he enlargeth the nations, and straiteneth them again.</i> | He increases the nations, and destroys them; he enlarges the nations, and confines them again. |
| 24 <i>He taketh away the heart of the chief of the people of the earth, and causeth them to wander in a wilderness where there is no way.</i> | He takes away the heart of the chief of the people of the earth, and causes them to wander in a wilderness where there is no way. |
| 25 <i>They grope in the dark without light, and he maketh them to stagger like a drunken man.</i> | They grope in the dark without light, and He makes them to stagger like a drunken man." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v7 — Isa 1:3

v9 — Isa 41:20; Jer 27:5-6; Rom 11:36; 1 Sam 2:7; Dan 9:17

v10 — Acts 17:28; Job 33:4; Acts 17:25; Num 16:22; Job 27:3

v11 — Job 34:3

v12 — Job 32:7; Job 15:10

v13 — Job 9:4; Job 36:5; Prov 2:6-7; Jas 1:5; Job 28:20-28

v14 — Rev 3:7; Isa 22:22

v17 — Isa 29:14; 1 Cor 1:19-20

v22 — Dan 2:22; 1 Cor 4:5; 1 Cor 2:10; Job 3:5; Luke 1:79

v23 — Isa 9:3; Isa 26:15

v24 — Ps 107:40; Job 12:20

v25 — Job 5:14; Ps 107:27

Chapter 13

Job demands to speak directly to the Almighty and accuses his friends of being worthless physicians who plaster over truth with lies. He declares he will maintain his ways before God and challenges God to show him his transgression.

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| 1 | <i>Lo, mine eye hath seen all this, mine ear hath heard and understood it.</i> | "My eye has seen all this, my ear has heard and understood it. |
| 2 | <i>What ye know, the same do I know also: I am not inferior to you.</i> | What You know, the same do I know also; I am not inferior to You. |
| 3 | <i>Surely I would speak to the Almighty, and I desire to reason with God.</i> | Surely I would speak to the Almighty, and I desire to reason with God. |
| 4 | <i>But ye are forgers of lies, ye are all physicians of no value.</i> | But You are forgers of lies, You are all physicians of no value. |
| 5 | <i>O that ye would altogether hold your peace! and it should be your wisdom.</i> | O that You would altogether hold Your peace! And it should be Your wisdom. |
| 6 | <i>Hear now my reasoning, and hearken to the pleadings of my lips.</i> | Hear now my reasoning, and listen to the pleadings of my lips. |
| 7 | <i>Will ye speak wickedly for God? and talk deceitfully for him?</i> | Will You speak wickedly for God? And talk deceitfully for Him? |
| 8 | <i>Will ye accept his person? will ye contend for God?</i> | Will You accept His person? Will You contend for God? |
| 9 | <i>Is it good that he should search you out? or as one man mocketh another, do ye so mock him?</i> | Is it good that He should search You out? Or as one man mocks another, do You so mock Him? |
| 10 | <i>He will surely reprove you, if ye do secretly accept persons.</i> | He will surely reprove You, if You secretly accept persons. |
| 11 | <i>Shall not his excellency make you afraid? and his dread fall upon you?</i> | Shall not His excellency make You afraid? And His dread fall on You? |

- 12 *Your remembrances are like unto ashes, your bodies to bodies of clay.* Your remembrances are like to ashes, Your bodies to bodies of clay.
- 13 *Hold your peace, let me alone, that I may speak, and let come on me what will.* Hold Your peace, let me alone, that I may speak, and let come on me what will.
- 14 *Wherefore do I take my flesh in my teeth, and put my life in mine hand?* Therefore do I take my flesh in my teeth, and put my life in my hand?
- 15 *Though he slay me, yet will I trust in him: but I will maintain mine own ways before him.* Though He slay me, yet will I trust in Him; but I will maintain my own ways before Him.
- 16 *He also shall be my salvation: for an hypocrite shall not come before him.* He also shall be my salvation; for a hypocrite shall not come before Him.
- 17 *Hear diligently my speech, and my declaration with your ears.* Hear diligently my speech, and my declaration with Your ears.
- 18 *Behold now, I have ordered my cause; I know that I shall be justified.* See now, I have ordered my cause; I know that I shall be justified.
- 19 *Who is he that will plead with me? for now, if I hold my tongue, I shall give up the ghost.* Who is He that will plead with me? For now, if I hold my tongue, I shall give up the ghost.
- 20 *Only do not two things unto me: then will I not hide myself from thee.* Only do not two things to me; then will I not hide myself from You.
- 21 *Withdraw thine hand far from me: and let not thy dread make me afraid.* Withdraw Your hand far from me, and let not Your dread make me afraid.
- 22 *Then call thou, and I will answer: or let me speak, and answer thou me.* Then call, and I will answer; or let me speak, and answer me.
- 23 *How many are mine iniquities and sins? make me to know my transgression and my sin.* How many are my iniquities and sins? Make me to know my transgression and my sin.
- 24 *Wherefore hidest thou thy face, and holdest me for thine enemy?* Therefore do You hide Your face, and hold me for Your enemy?
- 25 *Wilt thou break a leaf driven to and fro? and wilt thou pursue the dry stubble?* Will You break a leaf driven to and fro? And will You pursue the dry stubble?

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| <p>26 <i>For thou writest bitter things against me, and makest me to possess the iniquities of my youth.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Thou putttest my feet also in the stocks, and lookest narrowly unto all my paths; thou settest a print upon the heels of my feet.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And he, as a rotten thing, consumeth, as a garment that is moth eaten.</i></p> | <p>For You write bitter things against me, and make me to possess the iniquities of my youth.</p> <p>You put my feet also in the stocks, and look narrowly to all my paths; You set a print on the heels of my feet.</p> <p>And He, as a rotten thing, consumes, as a garment that is moth eaten.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Job 12:3
- v3 — Isa 41:21
- v4 — Ps 119:69
- v5 — Prov 17:28; Jas 1:19
- v9 — Gal 6:7-8; Jer 17:10; Ps 44:21
- v13 — Job 7:11
- v14 — Judg 12:3
- v15 — Ps 23:4; Job 23:10; Job 19:25-28; Rom 8:38-39; 1 John 3:20
- v16 — Isa 12:1-2
- v24 — Job 19:11; Ps 13:1; Lam 2:5
- v26 — Ps 25:7
- v27 — Job 33:11

Chapter 14

Job meditates on the frailty of man, born of woman and full of trouble like a flower that is cut down. He observes that a tree has hope if cut down, but when a man dies he lies down and rises not, and he longs for God to hide him in the grave until His wrath is past.

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| <p>1 <i>Man that is born of a woman is of few days, and full of trouble.</i></p> <p>2 <i>He cometh forth like a flower, and is cut down: he fleeth also as a shadow, and continueth not.</i></p> | <p>"Man that is born of a woman is of few days, and full of trouble.</p> <p>He comes forth like a flower, and is cut down; he flees also as a shadow, and does not continue.</p> |
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| 3 | <i>And dost thou open thine eyes upon such an one, and bringest me into judgment with thee?</i> | And do you open your eyes on such a one, and bring me into judgment with you? |
| 4 | <i>Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? not one.</i> | Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? Not one. |
| 5 | <i>Seeing his days are determined, the number of his months are with thee, thou hast appointed his bounds that he cannot pass;</i> | Seeing his days are determined, the number of his months are with you, you have appointed his bounds that he cannot pass; |
| 6 | <i>Turn from him, that he may rest, till he shall accomplish, as an hireling, his day.</i> | turn from him, that he may rest, till he shall accomplish, as a hireling, his day. |
| 7 | <i>For there is hope of a tree, if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branch thereof will not cease.</i> | For there is hope of a tree, if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branch of it will not cease. |
| 8 | <i>Though the root thereof wax old in the earth, and the stock thereof die in the ground;</i> | Though its root grows old in the earth, and the stock of it die in the ground, |
| 9 | <i>Yet through the scent of water it will bud, and bring forth boughs like a plant.</i> | yet through the scent of water it will bud, and bring forth boughs like a plant. |
| 10 | <i>But man dieth, and wasteth away: yea, man giveth up the ghost, and where is he?</i> | But man dies, and wastes away; yes, man gives up the ghost, and where is he? |
| 11 | <i>As the waters fail from the sea, and the flood decayeth and drieth up:</i> | As the waters fail from the sea, and the flood decays and dries up, |
| 12 | <i>So man lieth down, and riseth not: till the heavens be no more, they shall not awake, nor be raised out of their sleep.</i> | so man lies down, and rises not; till the heavens be no more, they shall not awake, nor be raised out of their sleep. |

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| 13 <i>O that thou wouldest hide me in the grave, that thou wouldest keep me secret, until thy wrath be past, that thou wouldest appoint me a set time, and remember me!</i> | O that you would hide me in the grave, that you would keep me secret, until your wrath be past, that you would appoint me a set time, and remember me! |
| 14 <i>If a man die, shall he live again? all the days of my appointed time will I wait, till my change come.</i> | If a man die, shall he live again? All the days of my appointed time will I wait, till my change come. |
| 15 <i>Thou shalt call, and I will answer thee: thou wilt have a desire to the work of thine hands.</i> | You shall call, and I will answer you; you will have a desire to the work of your hands. |
| 16 <i>For now thou numberest my steps: dost thou not watch over my sin?</i> | For now you number my steps; do you not watch over my sin? |
| 17 <i>My transgression is sealed up in a bag, and thou sewest up mine iniquity.</i> | My transgression is sealed up in a bag, and you sew up my iniquity. |
| 18 <i>And surely the mountain falling cometh to nought, and the rock is removed out of his place.</i> | And surely the mountain falling comes to nothing, and the rock is removed out of his place. |
| 19 <i>The waters wear the stones: thou washest away the things which grow out of the dust of the earth; and thou destroyest the hope of man.</i> | The waters wear the stones; you wash away the things which grow out of the dust of the earth; and you destroy the hope of man. |
| 20 <i>Thou prevailest for ever against him, and he passeth: thou changest his countenance, and sendest him away.</i> | You prevail for ever against him, and he passes; you change his countenance, and send him away. |
| 21 <i>His sons come to honour, and he knoweth it not; and they are brought low, but he perceiveth it not of them.</i> | His sons come to honour, and he does not know it; and they are brought low, but he does not see it of them. |
| 22 <i>He feeleth only the pain of his own flesh upon him, and his soul within him shall mourn.</i> | He feels only the pain of his own flesh on him, and his soul within him shall mourn." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Job 5:7; Job 25:4; Eccl 2:23; Matt 11:11; Job 7:1
v2 — Isa 40:6-8; 1 Pet 1:24; Job 8:9; Ps 103:15-16; Jas 4:14
v3 — Ps 144:3; Ps 143:2
v4 — John 3:6; Job 15:14; Rom 8:8-9; Eph 2:3
v5 — Ps 39:4; Acts 17:26; Job 12:10; Heb 9:27; Ps 104:29
v6 — Job 7:19; Ps 39:13; Job 7:1-2
v7 — Isa 27:6; Isa 11:1; Job 14:14; Dan 4:23-25; Job 19:10
v12 — Job 10:21-22; Eccl 3:19-21; Job 3:13; Isa 26:19; 2 Pet 3:10-13
v14 — 1 Cor 15:51-52; Ps 27:14; Job 7:1; Acts 26:8; John 5:28-29
v15 — Job 13:22; Ps 138:8
v16 — Job 10:6; Job 31:4
v17 — Deut 32:34; Hos 13:12

Chapter 15

Eliphaz begins his second speech, accusing Job of filling his belly with the east wind and undermining the fear of God. He insists that the wicked man writhes in pain all his days and that even the heavens are not clean in God's sight.

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| <p>1 <i>Then answered Eliphaz the Temanite, and said,</i></p> | Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered and said: |
| <p>2 <i>Should a wise man utter vain knowledge, and fill his belly with the east wind?</i></p> | "Should a wise man utter vain knowledge, and fill his belly with the east wind? |
| <p>3 <i>Should he reason with unprofitable talk? or with speeches wherewith he can do no good?</i></p> | Should he reason with unprofitable talk? Or with speeches with which he can do no good? |
| <p>4 <i>Yea, thou castest off fear, and restrainest prayer before God.</i></p> | Yes, you cast off fear, and restrain prayer before God. |
| <p>5 <i>For thy mouth uttereth thine iniquity, and thou choosest the tongue of the crafty.</i></p> | For your mouth utters your iniquity, and you choose the tongue of the crafty. |
| <p>6 <i>Thine own mouth condemneth thee, and not I: yea, thine own lips testify against thee.</i></p> | Your own mouth condemns you, and not I; yes, your own lips testify against you. |
| <p>7 <i>Art thou the first man that was born? or wast thou made before the hills?</i></p> | Are you the first man that was born? Or were you made before the hills? |

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| 8 <i>Hast thou heard the secret of God?
and dost thou restrain wisdom to
thyself?</i> | Have you heard the secret of God?
And do you restrain wisdom to
yourself? |
| 9 <i>What knowest thou, that we know not?
what understandest thou, which is not
in us?</i> | What do you know, that we do not
know? What do you understand, which
is not in us? |
| 10 <i>With us are both the grayheaded and
very aged men, much elder than thy
father.</i> | With us are both the grayheaded and
very aged men, much elder than your
father. |
| 11 <i>Are the consolations of God small
with thee? is there any secret thing
with thee?</i> | Are the consolations of God small with
you? Is there any secret thing with
you? |
| 12 <i>Why doth thine heart carry thee
away? and what do thy eyes wink at,</i> | Why does your heart carry you away?
And what do your eyes wink at, |
| 13 <i>That thou turnest thy spirit against
God, and lettest such words go out of
thy mouth?</i> | that you turn your spirit against God,
and let such words go out of your
mouth? |
| 14 <i>What is man, that he should be clean?
and he which is born of a woman, that
he should be righteous?</i> | What is man, that he should be clean?
And he which is born of a woman, that
he should be righteous? |
| 15 <i>Behold, he putteth no trust in his
saints; yea, the heavens are not clean
in his sight.</i> | See, he puts no trust in his saints; yes,
the heavens are not clean in his sight. |
| 16 <i>How much more abominable and
filthy is man, which drinketh iniquity
like water?</i> | How much more abominable and filthy
is man, who drinks iniquity like water? |
| 17 <i>I will shew thee, hear me; and that
which I have seen I will declare;</i> | I will show you, hear me; and that
which I have seen I will declare, |
| 18 <i>Which wise men have told from their
fathers, and have not hid it:</i> | which wise men have told from their
fathers, and have not hidden it, |
| 19 <i>Unto whom alone the land was given,
and no stranger passed among them:</i> | to whom alone the land was given, and
no stranger passed among them. |

- 20 *The wicked man travaileth with pain all his days, and the number of years is hidden to the oppressor.* The wicked man travails with pain all his days, and the number of years is hidden to the oppressor.
- 21 *A dreadful sound is in his ears: in prosperity the destroyer shall come upon him.* A dreadful sound is in his ears; in prosperity the destroyer shall come on him.
- 22 *He believeth not that he shall return out of darkness, and he is waited for of the sword.* He does not believe that he shall return out of darkness, and he is waited for of the sword.
- 23 *He wandereth abroad for bread, saying, Where is it? he knoweth that the day of darkness is ready at his hand:* He wanders abroad for bread, saying, 'Where is it?' He knows that the day of darkness is ready at his hand.
- 24 *Trouble and anguish shall make him afraid; they shall prevail against him, as a king ready to the battle.* Trouble and anguish shall make him afraid; they shall prevail against him, as a king ready to the battle.
- 25 *For he stretcheth out his hand against God, and strengtheneth himself against the Almighty.* For He stretches out His hand against God, and strengthens Himself against the Almighty.
- 26 *He runneth upon him, even on his neck, upon the thick bosses of his bucklers:* He runs on Him, even on His neck, on the thick bosses of His bucklers,
- 27 *Because he covereth his face with his fatness, and maketh collops of fat on his flanks.* because He covers His face with His fatness, and makes collops of fat on His flanks.
- 28 *And he dwelleth in desolate cities, and in houses which no man inhabiteth, which are ready to become heaps.* And He lives in desolate cities, and in houses which no man inhabits, which are ready to become heaps.
- 29 *He shall not be rich, neither shall his substance continue, neither shall he prolong the perfection thereof upon the earth.* He shall not be rich, neither shall His substance continue, neither shall He prolong the perfection of it on the earth.

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| <p>30 <i>He shall not depart out of darkness; the flame shall dry up his branches, and by the breath of his mouth shall he go away.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Let not him that is deceived trust in vanity: for vanity shall be his recompense.</i></p> <p>32 <i>It shall be accomplished before his time, and his branch shall not be green.</i></p> <p>33 <i>He shall shake off his unripe grape as the vine, and shall cast off his flower as the olive.</i></p> <p>34 <i>For the congregation of hypocrites shall be desolate, and fire shall consume the tabernacles of bribery.</i></p> <p>35 <i>They conceive mischief, and bring forth vanity, and their belly prepareth deceit.</i></p> | <p>He shall not depart out of darkness; the flame shall dry up His branches, and by the breath of His mouth shall He go away.</p> <p>Let not Him that is deceived trust in vanity; for vanity shall be His recompense.</p> <p>It shall be accomplished before His time, and His branch shall not be green.</p> <p>He shall shake off His unripe grape as the vine, and shall cast off His flower as the olive.</p> <p>For the congregation of hypocrites shall be desolate, and fire shall consume the tabernacles of bribery.</p> <p>They conceive mischief, and bring forth vanity, and their belly prepares deceit."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v6** — Luke 19:22; Matt 12:37; Job 9:20
- v7** — Ps 90:2
- v8** — Rom 11:34
- v9** — Job 13:2
- v14** — Eccl 7:20; Job 14:4; Prov 20:9; Rom 7:18; Job 25:4-6
- v15** — Job 25:5; Job 4:18
- v16** — Job 34:7; Prov 19:28
- v21** — Job 18:11; 1 Thess 5:3; Lev 26:36; 1 Cor 10:10
- v27** — Ps 17:10
- v31** — Isa 59:4; Gal 6:3
- v32** — Eccl 7:17; Ps 55:23
- v35** — Ps 7:14; Hos 10:13; Isa 59:4-5

Chapter 16

Job calls his friends miserable comforters and describes God as his adversary who has torn him apart and set him up as a target. Yet in the midst of his agony, Job declares that his witness is in heaven and his record is on high.

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| 1 <i>Then Job answered and said,</i> | Then Job answered and said: |
| 2 <i>I have heard many such things:
 miserable comforters are ye all.</i> | "I have heard many such things;
miserable comforters are you all. |
| 3 <i>Shall vain words have an end? or
 what emboldeneth thee that thou
 answerest?</i> | Shall vain words have an end? Or what
emboldens you that you answer? |
| 4 <i>I also could speak as ye do: if your
 soul were in my soul's stead, I could
 heap up words against you, and shake
 mine head at you.</i> | I also could speak as you do; if your
soul were in my soul's place, I could
heap up words against you, and shake
my head at you. |
| 5 <i>But I would strengthen you with my
 mouth, and the moving of my lips
 should assuage your grief.</i> | But I would strengthen you with my
mouth, and the moving of my lips
should assuage your grief. |
| 6 <i>Though I speak, my grief is not
 asswaged: and though I forbear, what
 am I eased?</i> | Though I speak, my grief is not
assuaged; and though I forbear, what
am I eased? |
| 7 <i>But now he hath made me weary: thou
 hast made desolate all my company.</i> | But now he has made me weary; you
have made desolate all my company. |
| 8 <i>And thou hast filled me with wrinkles,
 which is a witness against me: and my
 leanness rising up in me beareth
 witness to my face.</i> | And you have filled me with wrinkles,
which is a witness against me; and my
leanness rising up in me bears witness
to my face. |
| 9 <i>He teareth me in his wrath, who
 hateth me: he gnasheth upon me with
 his teeth; mine enemy sharpeneth his
 eyes upon me.</i> | He tears me in his wrath, who hates
me; he gnashes on me with his teeth;
my enemy sharpens his eyes on me. |
| 10 <i>They have gaped upon me with their
 mouth; they have smitten me upon the
 cheek reproachfully; they have
 gathered themselves together against
 me.</i> | They have gaped on me with their
mouth; they have struck me on the
cheek reproachfully; they have
gathered themselves together against
me. |

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| <p>11 <i>God hath delivered me to the ungodly, and turned me over into the hands of the wicked.</i></p> <p>12 <i>I was at ease, but he hath broken me asunder: he hath also taken me by my neck, and shaken me to pieces, and set me up for his mark.</i></p> <p>13 <i>His archers compass me round about, he cleaveth my reins asunder, and doth not spare; he poureth out my gall upon the ground.</i></p> <p>14 <i>He breaketh me with breach upon breach, he runneth upon me like a giant.</i></p> <p>15 <i>I have sewed sackcloth upon my skin, and defiled my horn in the dust.</i></p> <p>16 <i>My face is foul with weeping, and on my eyelids is the shadow of death;</i></p> <p>17 <i>Not for any injustice in mine hands: also my prayer is pure.</i></p> <p>18 <i>O earth, cover not thou my blood, and let my cry have no place.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Also now, behold, my witness is in heaven, and my record is on high.</i></p> <p>20 <i>My friends scorn me: but mine eye poureth out tears unto God.</i></p> <p>21 <i>O that one might plead for a man with God, as a man pleadeth for his neighbour!</i></p> <p>22 <i>When a few years are come, then I shall go the way whence I shall not return.</i></p> | <p>God has delivered me to the ungodly, and turned me over into the hands of the wicked.</p> <p>I was at ease, but he has broken me apart; he has also taken me by my neck, and shaken me to pieces, and set me up for his mark.</p> <p>His archers compass me round about; he cleaves my reins apart, and does not spare; he pours out my gall on the ground.</p> <p>He breaks me with breach on breach; he runs on me like a giant.</p> <p>I have sewed sackcloth on my skin, and defiled my horn in the dust.</p> <p>My face is foul with weeping, and on my eyelids is the shadow of death,</p> <p>not for any injustice in my hands; also my prayer is pure.</p> <p>O earth, do not cover my blood, and let my cry have no place.</p> <p>Also now, see, my witness is in heaven, and my record is on high.</p> <p>My friends scorn me; but my eye pours out tears to God.</p> <p>O that one might plead for a man with God, as a man pleads for his neighbour!</p> <p>When a few years are come, then I shall go the way from where I shall not return.</p> |
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Cross-References:

- v4** — Ps 109:25; Ps 22:7
v6 — Job 10:1
v8 — Job 10:17
v9 — Lam 2:16; Ps 35:16; Job 13:24
v10 — Ps 35:15; Ps 22:13; Isa 50:6; Lam 3:30; Acts 23:2
v12 — Job 7:20; Lam 3:11-12
v13 — Job 20:25
v15 — Gen 37:34
v17 — Prov 15:8
v19 — Rom 1:9
v20 — Heb 5:7; Ps 142:2
v21 — Eccl 6:10; Isa 45:9; Rom 9:20

Chapter 17

Job declares that his spirit is broken and his days are spent. He asks God to lay down a pledge for him, since no friend will vouch for him, and sees the grave as his only house and corruption as his father.

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| 1 | <i>My breath is corrupt, my days are extinct, the graves are ready for me.</i> | "My breath is corrupt, my days are extinct, the graves are ready for me. |
| 2 | <i>Are there not mockers with me? and doth not mine eye continue in their provocation?</i> | Are there not mockers with me? And does not my eye continue in their provocation? |
| 3 | <i>Lay down now, put me in a surety with thee; who is he that will strike hands with me?</i> | Lay down now, put me in a surety with you; who is he that will strike hands with me? |
| 4 | <i>For thou hast hid their heart from understanding: therefore shalt thou not exalt them.</i> | For you have hidden their heart from understanding; therefore shall you not exalt them. |
| 5 | <i>He that speaketh flattery to his friends, even the eyes of his children shall fail.</i> | He that speaks flattery to his friends, even the eyes of his children shall fail. |
| 6 | <i>He hath made me also a byword of the people; and aforetime I was as a tabret.</i> | He has made me also a byword of the people; and before I was as a tabret. |

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| 7 <i>Mine eye also is dim by reason of sorrow, and all my members are as a shadow.</i> | My eye also is dim by reason of sorrow, and all my members are as a shadow. |
| 8 <i>Upright men shall be astonished at this, and the innocent shall stir up himself against the hypocrite.</i> | Upright men shall be astonished at this, and the innocent shall stir up himself against the hypocrite. |
| 9 <i>The righteous also shall hold on his way, and he that hath clean hands shall be stronger and stronger.</i> | The righteous also shall hold on his way, and he that has clean hands shall be stronger and stronger. |
| 10 <i>But as for you all, do ye return, and come now: for I cannot find one wise man among you.</i> | But as for you all, do return, and come now; for I cannot find one wise man among you. |
| 11 <i>My days are past, my purposes are broken off, even the thoughts of my heart.</i> | My days are past, my purposes are broken off, even the thoughts of my heart. |
| 12 <i>They change the night into day: the light is short because of darkness.</i> | They change the night into day; the light is short because of darkness. |
| 13 <i>If I wait, the grave is mine house: I have made my bed in the darkness.</i> | If I wait, the grave is my house; I have made my bed in the darkness. |
| 14 <i>I have said to corruption, Thou art my father: to the worm, Thou art my mother, and my sister.</i> | I have said to corruption, 'You are my father'; to the worm, 'You are my mother, and my sister.' |
| 15 <i>And where is now my hope? as for my hope, who shall see it?</i> | And where is now my hope? As for my hope, who shall see it? |
| 16 <i>They shall go down to the bars of the pit, when our rest together is in the dust.</i> | They shall go down to the bars of the pit, when our rest together is in the dust." |

Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

v1 — Isa 38:10-14

v4 — Matt 11:25; Matt 13:11

v6 — Ps 44:14; Job 30:9

v9 — Prov 4:18; Isa 1:15-16; Job 22:30; Ps 84:7; Prov 14:16

v11 — Job 7:6; Isa 38:10

Chapter 18

Bildad begins his second speech, painting a vivid picture of the fate awaiting the wicked. He describes traps, terrors, disease, and destruction that consume the sinner, whose memory perishes from the earth and who is driven from light into darkness.

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| 1 | <i>Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,</i> | Then Bildad the Shuhite answered and said: |
| 2 | <i>How long will it be ere ye make an end of words? mark, and afterwards we will speak.</i> | "How long will it be before you make an end of words? Mark, and afterwards we will speak. |
| 3 | <i>Wherefore are we counted as beasts, and reputed vile in your sight?</i> | Why are we counted as beasts, and reputed vile in your sight? |
| 4 | <i>He teareth himself in his anger: shall the earth be forsaken for thee? and shall the rock be removed out of his place?</i> | He tears himself in his anger; shall the earth be forsaken for you? And shall the rock be removed out of his place? |
| 5 | <i>Yea, the light of the wicked shall be put out, and the spark of his fire shall not shine.</i> | Yes, the light of the wicked shall be put out, and the spark of his fire shall not shine. |
| 6 | <i>The light shall be dark in his tabernacle, and his candle shall be put out with him.</i> | The light shall be dark in his tabernacle, and his candle shall be put out with him. |
| 7 | <i>The steps of his strength shall be straitened, and his own counsel shall cast him down.</i> | The steps of his strength shall be straitened, and his own counsel shall cast him down. |
| 8 | <i>For he is cast into a net by his own feet, and he walketh upon a snare.</i> | For he is cast into a net by his own feet, and he walks on a snare. |
| 9 | <i>The gin shall take him by the heel, and the robber shall prevail against him.</i> | The gin shall take him by the heel, and the robber shall prevail against him. |
| 10 | <i>The snare is laid for him in the ground, and a trap for him in the way.</i> | The snare is laid for him in the ground, and a trap for him in the way. |

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| <p>11 <i>Terrors shall make him afraid on every side, and shall drive him to his feet.</i></p> <p>12 <i>His strength shall be hungerbitten, and destruction shall be ready at his side.</i></p> <p>13 <i>It shall devour the strength of his skin: even the firstborn of death shall devour his strong joints.</i></p> <p>14 <i>His confidence shall be rooted out of his tabernacle, and it shall bring him to the king of terrors.</i></p> <p>15 <i>It shall dwell in his tabernacle, because it is none of his: brimstone shall be scattered upon his habitation.</i></p> <p>16 <i>His roots shall be dried up beneath, and above shall his branch be cut off.</i></p> <p>17 <i>His remembrance shall perish from the earth, and he shall have no name in the street.</i></p> <p>18 <i>He shall be driven from light into darkness, and chased out of the world.</i></p> <p>19 <i>He shall neither have son nor nephew among his people, nor any remaining in his dwellings.</i></p> <p>20 <i>They that come after him shall be astonished at his day, as they that went before were affrighted.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Surely such are the dwellings of the wicked, and this is the place of him that knoweth not God.</i></p> | <p>Terrors shall make him afraid on every side, and shall drive him to his feet.</p> <p>His strength shall be hunger-bitten, and destruction shall be ready at his side.</p> <p>It shall devour the strength of his skin; even the firstborn of death shall devour his strong joints.</p> <p>His confidence shall be rooted out of his tabernacle, and it shall bring him to the king of terrors.</p> <p>It shall dwell in his tabernacle, because it is none of his; brimstone shall be scattered on his habitation.</p> <p>His roots shall be dried up beneath, and above shall his branch be cut off.</p> <p>His remembrance shall perish from the earth, and he shall have no name in the street.</p> <p>He shall be driven from light into darkness, and chased out of the world.</p> <p>He shall neither have son nor nephew among his people, nor any remaining in his dwellings.</p> <p>They that come after him shall be astonished at his day, as they that went before were frightened.</p> <p>Surely such are the dwellings of the wicked, and this is the place of him that does not know God."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Ps 73:22
 v5 — Prov 13:9; Prov 20:20; Prov 24:20; Job 21:17
 v8 — Ps 9:15
 v11 — Job 15:21; Jer 6:25
 v15 — Ps 11:6
 v16 — Hos 9:16; Isa 5:24
 v17 — Ps 34:16; Prov 10:7; Ps 109:13
 v18 — Job 20:8
 v19 — Jer 22:30
 v20 — Ps 37:13
 v21 — Titus 1:16; Jer 9:3

Chapter 19

Job cries out that God has overthrown him and stripped him of his glory, turning family and friends against him. Yet he makes his greatest declaration of faith: "I know that my redeemer lives, and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth."

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| 1 <i>Then Job answered and said,</i> | Then Job answered and said: |
| 2 <i>How long will ye vex my soul, and
break me in pieces with words?</i> | "How long will you vex my soul, and
break me in pieces with words? |
| 3 <i>These ten times have ye reproached
me: ye are not ashamed that ye make
yourselves strange to me.</i> | These ten times have you reproached
me; you are not ashamed that you
make yourselves strange to me. |
| 4 <i>And be it indeed that I have erred,
mine error remaineth with myself.</i> | And be it indeed that I have erred, my
error remains with myself. |
| 5 <i>If indeed ye will magnify yourselves
against me, and plead against me my
reproach:</i> | If indeed you will magnify yourselves
against me, and plead against me my
reproach, |
| 6 <i>Know now that God hath overthrown
me, and hath compassed me with his
net.</i> | know now that God has overthrown
me, and has compassed me with His
net. |
| 7 <i>Behold, I cry out of wrong, but I am
not heard: I cry aloud, but there is no
judgment.</i> | See, I cry out of wrong, but I am not
heard; I cry aloud, but there is no
judgment. |

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| 8 <i>He hath fenced up my way that I cannot pass, and he hath set darkness in my paths.</i> | He has fenced up my way that I cannot pass, and he has set darkness in my paths. |
| 9 <i>He hath stripped me of my glory, and taken the crown from my head.</i> | He has stripped me of my glory, and taken the crown from my head. |
| 10 <i>He hath destroyed me on every side, and I am gone: and mine hope hath he removed like a tree.</i> | He has destroyed me on every side, and I am gone; and my hope has he removed like a tree. |
| 11 <i>He hath also kindled his wrath against me, and he counteth me unto him as one of his enemies.</i> | He has also kindled his wrath against me, and he counts me to him as one of his enemies. |
| 12 <i>His troops come together, and raise up their way against me, and encamp round about my tabernacle.</i> | His troops come together, and raise up their way against me, and encamp round about my tabernacle. |
| 13 <i>He hath put my brethren far from me, and mine acquaintance are verily estranged from me.</i> | He has put my brethren far from me, and my acquaintance are truly estranged from me. |
| 14 <i>My kinsfolk have failed, and my familiar friends have forgotten me.</i> | My kinsfolk have failed, and my familiar friends have forgotten me. |
| 15 <i>They that dwell in mine house, and my maids, count me for a stranger: I am an alien in their sight.</i> | They that live in my house, and my maids, count me for a stranger; I am an alien in their sight. |
| 16 <i>I called my servant, and he gave me no answer; I entreated him with my mouth.</i> | I called my servant, and he gave me no answer; I entreated him with my mouth. |
| 17 <i>My breath is strange to my wife, though I entreated for the children's sake of mine own body.</i> | My breath is strange to my wife, though I entreated for the children's sake of my own body. |
| 18 <i>Yea, young children despised me; I arose, and they spake against me.</i> | Yes, young children despised me; I arose, and they spoke against me. |
| 19 <i>All my inward friends abhorred me: and they whom I loved are turned against me.</i> | All my inward friends abhorred me; and they whom I loved are turned against me. |

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| <p>20 <i>My bone cleaveth to my skin and to my flesh, and I am escaped with the skin of my teeth.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Have pity upon me, have pity upon me, O ye my friends; for the hand of God hath touched me.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Why do ye persecute me as God, and are not satisfied with my flesh?</i></p> <p>23 <i>Oh that my words were now written! oh that they were printed in a book!</i></p> <p>24 <i>That they were graven with an iron pen and lead in the rock for ever!</i></p> <p>25 <i>For I know that my redeemer liveth, and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth:</i></p> | <p>My bone cleaves to my skin and to my flesh, and I have escaped with the skin of my teeth.</p> <p>Have pity on me, have pity on me, O my friends; for the hand of God has touched me.</p> <p>Why do you persecute me as God, and are not satisfied with my flesh?</p> <p>Oh that my words were now written! Oh that they were printed in a book!</p> <p>That they were engraved with an iron pen and lead in the rock for ever!</p> <p>For I know that my redeemer lives, and that He shall stand at the latter day on the earth;</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redeemer** (ree-DEE-mer) — "one who pays the price to buy back what was lost; a kinsman who redeems." Job's declaration here reaches beyond his own suffering to anticipate the coming Christ who will stand upon the earth.

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| <p>26 <i>And though after my skin worms destroy this body, yet in my flesh shall I see God:</i></p> <p>27 <i>Whom I shall see for myself, and mine eyes shall behold, and not another; though my reins be consumed within me.</i></p> <p>28 <i>But ye should say, Why persecute we him, seeing the root of the matter is found in me?</i></p> <p>29 <i>Be ye afraid of the sword: for wrath bringeth the punishments of the sword, that ye may know there is a judgment.</i></p> | <p>and though after my skin worms destroy this body, yet in my flesh shall I see God,</p> <p>whom I shall see for myself, and my eyes shall see, and not another; though my reins be consumed within me.</p> <p>But You should say, 'Why do we persecute Him, seeing the root of the matter is found in me?'</p> <p>Be afraid of the sword; for wrath brings the punishments of the sword, that You may know there is a judgment."</p> |
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Cross-References:

- v3** — Gen 31:7
v5 — Ps 35:26; Ps 55:12; Ps 38:16
v7 — Hab 1:2-3; Lam 3:8
v8 — Job 3:23; Lam 3:7; Lam 3:9; Ps 88:8; Prov 4:19
v9 — Ps 89:44
v10 — Job 24:20; Ps 37:35-36
v11 — Job 13:24; Job 33:10; Job 16:9
v12 — Job 30:12
v13 — Ps 88:8; Ps 69:8; Ps 88:18
v20 — Ps 102:5
v25 — Eph 1:7; Isa 54:5; Ps 78:35; Prov 23:11; Ps 19:14
v26 — Matt 5:8; 1 John 3:2; Ps 17:15; Rev 1:7; 1 Cor 13:12

Chapter 20

Zophar begins his second speech, insisting that the triumphing of the wicked is short. He describes how the sinner's ill-gotten wealth will be swallowed up, God's wrath will rain down on him, and the earth will rise up against him.

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| <p>1 <i>Then answered Zophar the Naamathite, and said,</i></p> | Then Zophar the Naamathite answered and said: |
| <p>2 <i>Therefore do my thoughts cause me to answer, and for this I make haste.</i></p> | "Therefore do my thoughts cause me to answer, and for this I make haste. |
| <p>3 <i>I have heard the check of my reproach, and the spirit of my understanding causeth me to answer.</i></p> | I have heard the check of my reproach, and the spirit of my understanding causes me to answer. |
| <p>4 <i>Knowest thou not this of old, since man was placed upon earth,</i></p> | Do you not know this of old, since man was placed on earth, |
| <p>5 <i>That the triumphing of the wicked is short, and the joy of the hypocrite but for a moment?</i></p> | that the triumphing of the wicked is short, and the joy of the hypocrite but for a moment? |
| <p>6 <i>Though his excellency mount up to the heavens, and his head reach unto the clouds;</i></p> | Though his excellency mount up to the heavens, and his head reach to the clouds, |
| <p>7 <i>Yet he shall perish for ever like his own dung: they which have seen him shall say, Where is he?</i></p> | yet he shall perish for ever like his own dung; they which have seen him shall say, 'Where is he?' |

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| 8 <i>He shall fly away as a dream, and shall not be found: yea, he shall be chased away as a vision of the night.</i> | He shall fly away as a dream, and shall not be found; yes, he shall be chased away as a vision of the night. |
| 9 <i>The eye also which saw him shall see him no more; neither shall his place any more behold him.</i> | The eye also which saw him shall see him no more; neither shall his place any more see him. |
| 10 <i>His children shall seek to please the poor, and his hands shall restore their goods.</i> | His children shall seek to please the poor, and his hands shall restore their goods. |
| 11 <i>His bones are full of the sin of his youth, which shall lie down with him in the dust.</i> | His bones are full of the sin of his youth, which shall lie down with him in the dust. |
| 12 <i>Though wickedness be sweet in his mouth, though he hide it under his tongue;</i> | Though wickedness be sweet in his mouth, though he hide it under his tongue, |
| 13 <i>Though he spare it, and forsake it not; but keep it still within his mouth:</i> | though he spare it, and forsake it not, but keep it still within his mouth, |
| 14 <i>Yet his meat in his bowels is turned, it is the gall of asps within him.</i> | yet his meat in his bowels is turned; it is the gall of asps within him. |
| 15 <i>He hath swallowed down riches, and he shall vomit them up again: God shall cast them out of his belly.</i> | He has swallowed down riches, and he shall vomit them up again; God shall cast them out of His belly. |
| 16 <i>He shall suck the poison of asps: the viper's tongue shall slay him.</i> | He shall suck the poison of asps; the viper's tongue shall slay him. |
| 17 <i>He shall not see the rivers, the floods, the brooks of honey and butter.</i> | He shall not see the rivers, the floods, the brooks of honey and butter. |
| 18 <i>That which he laboured for shall he restore, and shall not swallow it down: according to his substance shall the restitution be, and he shall not rejoice therein.</i> | That which he laboured for shall he restore, and shall not swallow it down; according to his substance shall the restitution be, and he shall not rejoice in it. |

- 19 *Because he hath oppressed and hath forsaken the poor; because he hath violently taken away an house which he builded not;* Because he has oppressed and has forsaken the poor; because he has violently taken away a house which he did not build;
- 20 *Surely he shall not feel quietness in his belly, he shall not save of that which he desired.* surely he shall not feel quietness in his belly, he shall not save of that which he desired.
- 21 *There shall none of his meat be left; therefore shall no man look for his goods.* There shall none of his meat be left; therefore shall no man look for his goods.
- 22 *In the fulness of his sufficiency he shall be in straits: every hand of the wicked shall come upon him.* In the fulness of his sufficiency he shall be in straits; every hand of the wicked shall come on him.
- 23 *When he is about to fill his belly, God shall cast the fury of his wrath upon him, and shall rain it upon him while he is eating.* When he is about to fill his belly, God shall cast the fury of His wrath on Him, and shall rain it on Him while He is eating.
- 24 *He shall flee from the iron weapon, and the bow of steel shall strike him through.* He shall flee from the iron weapon, and the bow of steel shall strike him through.
- 25 *It is drawn, and cometh out of the body; yea, the glittering sword cometh out of his gall: terrors are upon him.* It is drawn, and comes out of the body; yes, the glittering sword comes out of his gall; terrors are on him.
- 26 *All darkness shall be hid in his secret places: a fire not blown shall consume him; it shall go ill with him that is left in his tabernacle.* All darkness shall be hidden in his secret places; a fire not blown shall consume him; it shall go ill with him that is left in his tabernacle.
- 27 *The heaven shall reveal his iniquity; and the earth shall rise up against him.* The heaven shall reveal his iniquity, and the earth shall rise up against him.
- 28 *The increase of his house shall depart, and his goods shall flow away in the day of his wrath.* The increase of his house shall depart, and his goods shall flow away in the day of his wrath.

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| <p>29 <i>This is the portion of a wicked man from God, and the heritage appointed unto him by God.</i></p> | <p>This is the portion of a wicked man from God, and the heritage appointed to Him by God."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v5 — Ps 37:35-36
- v6 — Obad 1:3-4; Isa 14:13-14
- v8 — Ps 90:5; Ps 73:20
- v9 — Job 7:8; Job 8:18; Job 7:10
- v11 — Job 13:26
- v12 — Ps 10:7; Job 15:16
- v15 — Prov 23:8; Matt 27:3-4
- v23 — Ps 78:30-31; Num 11:33
- v24 — Isa 24:18; Amos 5:19
- v25 — Job 16:13; Job 18:11
- v26 — Ps 21:9
- v29 — Job 27:13; Job 31:2-3

Chapter 21

Job directly challenges the retribution theology of his friends, pointing out that the wicked often prosper, live long, and die in peace. He asks why the wicked are not punished in their own lifetime and declares that his friends' answers are nothing but falsehood.

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| <p>1 <i>But Job answered and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Hear diligently my speech, and let this be your consolations.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Suffer me that I may speak; and after that I have spoken, mock on.</i></p> <p>4 <i>As for me, is my complaint to man? and if it were so, why should not my spirit be troubled?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Mark me, and be astonished, and lay your hand upon your mouth.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Even when I remember I am afraid, and trembling taketh hold on my flesh.</i></p> | <p>But Job answered and said:</p> <p>"Hear diligently my speech, and let this be your consolations.</p> <p>Allow me that I may speak; and after that I have spoken, mock on.</p> <p>As for me, is my complaint to man? And if it were so, why should not my spirit be troubled?</p> <p>Mark me, and be astonished, and lay your hand on your mouth.</p> <p>Even when I remember I am afraid, and trembling takes hold on my flesh.</p> |
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| 7 | <i>Wherefore do the wicked live, become old, yea, are mighty in power?</i> | Why do the wicked live, become old, yes, are mighty in power? |
| 8 | <i>Their seed is established in their sight with them, and their offspring before their eyes.</i> | Their seed is established in their sight with them, and their offspring before their eyes. |
| 9 | <i>Their houses are safe from fear, neither is the rod of God upon them.</i> | Their houses are safe from fear, neither is the rod of God on them. |
| 10 | <i>Their bull gendereth, and faileth not; their cow calveth, and casteth not her calf.</i> | Their bull breeds, and does not fail; their cow calves, and does not cast her calf. |
| 11 | <i>They send forth their little ones like a flock, and their children dance.</i> | They send forth their little ones like a flock, and their children dance. |
| 12 | <i>They take the timbrel and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ.</i> | They take the timbrel and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ. |
| 13 | <i>They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave.</i> | They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave. |
| 14 | <i>Therefore they say unto God, Depart from us; for we desire not the knowledge of thy ways.</i> | Therefore they say to God, 'Depart from us; for we do not desire the knowledge of your ways. |
| 15 | <i>What is the Almighty, that we should serve him? and what profit should we have, if we pray unto him?</i> | What is the Almighty, that we should serve Him? And what profit should we have, if we pray to Him?' |
| 16 | <i>Lo, their good is not in their hand: the counsel of the wicked is far from me.</i> | Their good is not in their hand; the counsel of the wicked is far from me. |
| 17 | <i>How oft is the candle of the wicked put out! and how oft cometh their destruction upon them! God distributeth sorrows in his anger.</i> | How often is the candle of the wicked put out! And how often comes their destruction on them! God distributes sorrows in His anger. |
| 18 | <i>They are as stubble before the wind, and as chaff that the storm carrieth away.</i> | They are as stubble before the wind, and as chaff that the storm carries away. |

- 19 *God layeth up his iniquity for his children: he rewardeth him, and he shall know it.* God lays up His iniquity for His children; He rewards Him, and He shall know it.
- 20 *His eyes shall see his destruction, and he shall drink of the wrath of the Almighty.* His eyes shall see His destruction, and He shall drink of the wrath of the Almighty.
- 21 *For what pleasure hath he in his house after him, when the number of his months is cut off in the midst?* For what pleasure has He in His house after Him, when the number of His months is cut off in the midst?
- 22 *Shall any teach God knowledge? seeing he judgeth those that are high.* Shall any teach God knowledge? Seeing He judges those that are high.
- 23 *One dieth in his full strength, being wholly at ease and quiet.* One dies in His full strength, being wholly at ease and quiet.
- 24 *His breasts are full of milk, and his bones are moistened with marrow.* His breasts are full of milk, and His bones are moistened with marrow.
- 25 *And another dieth in the bitterness of his soul, and never eateth with pleasure.* And another dies in the bitterness of His soul, and never eats with pleasure.
- 26 *They shall lie down alike in the dust, and the worms shall cover them.* They shall lie down alike in the dust, and the worms shall cover them.
- 27 *Behold, I know your thoughts, and the devices which ye wrongfully imagine against me.* See, I know Your thoughts, and the devices which You wrongfully imagine against me.
- 28 *For ye say, Where is the house of the prince? and where are the dwelling places of the wicked?* For you say, 'Where is the house of the prince? And where are the dwelling places of the wicked?'
- 29 *Have ye not asked them that go by the way? and do ye not know their tokens,* Have you not asked them that go by the way? And do you not know their tokens,
- 30 *That the wicked is reserved to the day of destruction? they shall be brought forth to the day of wrath.* that the wicked is reserved to the day of destruction? They shall be brought forth to the day of wrath.

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| <p>31 <i>Who shall declare his way to his face?
and who shall repay him what he hath
done?</i></p> <p>32 <i>Yet shall he be brought to the grave,
and shall remain in the tomb.</i></p> <p>33 <i>The clods of the valley shall be sweet
unto him, and every man shall draw
after him, as there are innumerable
before him.</i></p> <p>34 <i>How then comfort ye me in vain,
seeing in your answers there
remaineth falsehood?</i></p> | <p>Who shall declare his way to his face?
And who shall repay him what he has
done?</p> <p>Yet shall he be brought to the grave,
and shall remain in the tomb.</p> <p>The clods of the valley shall be sweet
to him, and every man shall draw after
him, as there are innumerable before
him.</p> <p>How then do you comfort me in vain,
seeing in your answers there remains
falsehood?"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v5 — Job 40:4; Job 29:9; Judg 18:19
v7 — Ps 73:3-12; Job 12:6; Ps 37:35; Jer 12:1-3
v10 — Ex 23:26
v14 — Job 22:17; Rom 8:7
v15 — Ex 5:2; Job 34:9
v16 — Job 22:18; Ps 1:1
v18 — Ps 1:4; Ps 83:13; Ps 35:5; Job 13:25
v19 — Ex 20:5
v20 — Ps 75:8; Rev 14:10; Isa 51:17
v22 — Rom 11:34
v26 — Eccl 9:2; Isa 14:11; Job 20:11
v30 — Prov 16:4

Chapter 22

Eliphaz begins his third and harshest speech, accusing Job of specific sins: stripping the naked, withholding bread from the hungry, and crushing widows and orphans. He urges Job to return to the Almighty and put away iniquity so that he may be restored.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered
and said,</i></p> | <p>Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered
and said:</p> |
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| <p>2 <i>Can a man be profitable unto God, as he that is wise may be profitable unto himself?</i></p> <p>3 <i>Is it any pleasure to the Almighty, that thou art righteous? or is it gain to him, that thou makest thy ways perfect?</i></p> <p>4 <i>Will he reprove thee for fear of thee? will he enter with thee into judgment?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Is not thy wickedness great? and thine iniquities infinite?</i></p> <p>6 <i>For thou hast taken a pledge from thy brother for nought, and stripped the naked of their clothing.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Thou hast not given water to the weary to drink, and thou hast withholden bread from the hungry.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But as for the mighty man, he had the earth; and the honourable man dwelt in it.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Thou hast sent widows away empty, and the arms of the fatherless have been broken.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Therefore snares are round about thee, and sudden fear troubleth thee;</i></p> <p>11 <i>Or darkness, that thou canst not see; and abundance of waters cover thee.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Is not God in the height of heaven? and behold the height of the stars, how high they are!</i></p> <p>13 <i>And thou sayest, How doth God know? can he judge through the dark cloud?</i></p> | <p>"Can a man be profitable to God, as He that is wise may be profitable to himself?</p> <p>Is it any pleasure to the Almighty, that You are righteous? Or is it gain to Him, that You make Your ways perfect?</p> <p>Will He reprove You for fear of You? Will He enter with You into judgment?</p> <p>Is not Your wickedness great? And Your iniquities infinite?</p> <p>For You have taken a pledge from Your brother for nothing, and stripped the naked of their clothing.</p> <p>You have not given water to the weary to drink, and You have withheld bread from the hungry.</p> <p>But as for the mighty man, He had the earth; and the honourable man lived in it.</p> <p>You have sent widows away empty, and the arms of the fatherless have been broken.</p> <p>Therefore snares are round about You, and sudden fear troubles You;</p> <p>or darkness, that You cannot see; and abundance of waters cover You.</p> <p>Is not God in the height of heaven? And see the height of the stars, how high they are!</p> <p>And You say, 'How does God know? Can He judge through the dark cloud?</p> |
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- 14 *Thick clouds are a covering to him, that he seeth not; and he walketh in the circuit of heaven.* Thick clouds are a covering to Him, that He does not see; and He walks in the circuit of heaven.'
- 15 *Hast thou marked the old way which wicked men have trodden?* Have You marked the old way which wicked men have trodden?
- 16 *Which were cut down out of time, whose foundation was overflown with a flood:* who were cut down out of time, whose foundation was overflown with a flood,
- 17 *Which said unto God, Depart from us: and what can the Almighty do for them?* who said to God, 'Depart from us'; and what can the Almighty do for them?
- 18 *Yet he filled their houses with good things: but the counsel of the wicked is far from me.* Yet he filled their houses with good things; but the counsel of the wicked is far from me.
- 19 *The righteous see it, and are glad: and the innocent laugh them to scorn.* The righteous see it, and are glad; and the innocent laugh them to scorn.
- 20 *Whereas our substance is not cut down, but the remnant of them the fire consumeth.* Whereas our substance is not cut down, but the remnant of them the fire consumes.
- 21 *Acquaint now thyself with him, and be at peace: thereby good shall come unto thee.* Acquaint now yourself with him, and be at peace; thereby good shall come to you.
- 22 *Receive, I pray thee, the law from his mouth, and lay up his words in thine heart.* Receive, I pray you, the law from his mouth, and lay up his words in your heart.
- 23 *If thou return to the Almighty, thou shalt be built up, thou shalt put away iniquity far from thy tabernacles.* If You return to the Almighty, You shall be built up; You shall put away iniquity far from Your tabernacles.
- 24 *Then shalt thou lay up gold as dust, and the gold of Ophir as the stones of the brooks.* Then shall You lay up gold as dust, and the gold of Ophir as the stones of the brooks.
- 25 *Yea, the Almighty shall be thy defence, and thou shalt have plenty of silver.* Yes, the Almighty shall be Your defence, and You shall have plenty of silver.

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| <p>26 <i>For then shalt thou have thy delight in the Almighty, and shalt lift up thy face unto God.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Thou shalt make thy prayer unto him, and he shall hear thee, and thou shalt pay thy vows.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Thou shalt also decree a thing, and it shall be established unto thee: and the light shall shine upon thy ways.</i></p> <p>29 <i>When men are cast down, then thou shalt say, There is lifting up; and he shall save the humble person.</i></p> <p>30 <i>He shall deliver the island of the innocent: and it is delivered by the pureness of thine hands.</i></p> | <p>For then shall You have Your delight in the Almighty, and shall lift up Your face to God.</p> <p>You shall make Your prayer to Him, and He shall hear You, and You shall pay Your vows.</p> <p>You shall also decree a thing, and it shall be established to You; and the light shall shine on Your ways.</p> <p>When men are cast down, then You shall say, 'There is lifting up'; and He shall save the humble person.</p> <p>He shall deliver the island of the innocent; and it is delivered by the pureness of Your hands."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Cor 7:1; Prov 15:8; Prov 11:1; Prov 12:22; Ps 147:10-11
- v6 — Ex 22:26; Ezek 18:12; Ezek 18:16
- v13 — Ezek 8:12; Ps 10:11; Ezek 9:9; Ps 73:11
- v21 — 1 Chr 28:9; Isa 27:5; Ps 34:10; Phil 4:7; Eph 2:14-17
- v22 — Ps 119:11; Job 23:12; Deut 6:6-9; Deut 4:1-2; Jer 15:16
- v23 — Zech 1:3; Job 11:13-14; Job 8:5-6; Isa 55:6-7
- v25 — Ps 16:5-6; Isa 33:6; Gen 15:1; Ps 18:2; Ps 84:11
- v26 — Ps 37:4; Isa 58:14; Job 27:10; Job 11:15; Rom 7:22
- v27 — Isa 58:9; Ps 116:1; 1 John 5:14-15; Ps 50:14-15; Ps 91:15
- v28 — Matt 21:22; Ps 90:17; Ps 20:4; Isa 30:21; Prov 4:18
- v29 — Job 5:19-27; Jas 4:6; 1 Pet 5:5; Luke 1:52; Matt 23:12
- v30 — Job 42:7-8; Jas 5:15-16; Gen 18:26-32; Ps 18:20

Chapter 23

Job longs to find God and present his case before Him, confident that he would be acquitted. He declares that God knows the way he takes and that when He has tried him, he shall come forth as gold, yet God's unsearchable will terrifies him.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Job answered and said,</i></p> | <p>Then Job answered and said:</p> |
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| 2 | <i>Even to day is my complaint bitter: my stroke is heavier than my groaning.</i> | "Even today is my complaint bitter; my stroke is heavier than my groaning. |
| 3 | <i>Oh that I knew where I might find him! that I might come even to his seat!</i> | Oh that I knew where I might find him! That I might come even to his seat! |
| 4 | <i>I would order my cause before him, and fill my mouth with arguments.</i> | I would order my cause before him, and fill my mouth with arguments. |
| 5 | <i>I would know the words which he would answer me, and understand what he would say unto me.</i> | I would know the words which he would answer me, and understand what he would say to me. |
| 6 | <i>Will he plead against me with his great power? No; but he would put strength in me.</i> | Will he plead against me with his great power? No; but he would put strength in me. |
| 7 | <i>There the righteous might dispute with him; so should I be delivered for ever from my judge.</i> | There the righteous might dispute with him; so should I be delivered for ever from my judge. |
| 8 | <i>Behold, I go forward, but he is not there; and backward, but I cannot perceive him:</i> | See, I go forward, but he is not there; and backward, but I cannot see him. |
| 9 | <i>On the left hand, where he doth work, but I cannot behold him: he hideth himself on the right hand, that I cannot see him:</i> | On the left hand, where he does work, but I cannot see him; he hides himself on the right hand, that I cannot see him. |
| 10 | <i>But he knoweth the way that I take: when he hath tried me, I shall come forth as gold.</i> | But he knows the way that I take; when he has tried me, I shall come forth as gold. |
| 11 | <i>My foot hath held his steps, his way have I kept, and not declined.</i> | My foot has held his steps; his way have I kept, and not declined. |
| 12 | <i>Neither have I gone back from the commandment of his lips; I have esteemed the words of his mouth more than my necessary food.</i> | Neither have I gone back from the commandment of his lips; I have esteemed the words of his mouth more than my necessary food. |

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| <p>13 <i>But he is in one mind, and who can turn him? and what his soul desireth, even that he doeth.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For he performeth the thing that is appointed for me: and many such things are with him.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Therefore am I troubled at his presence: when I consider, I am afraid of him.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For God maketh my heart soft, and the Almighty troubleth me:</i></p> <p>17 <i>Because I was not cut off before the darkness, neither hath he covered the darkness from my face.</i></p> | <p>But he is in one mind, and who can turn him? And what his soul desires, even that he does.</p> <p>For he performs the thing that is appointed for me; and many such things are with him.</p> <p>Therefore am I troubled at his presence; when I consider, I am afraid of him.</p> <p>For God makes my heart soft, and the Almighty troubles me.</p> <p>Because I was not cut off before the darkness, neither has He covered the darkness from my face.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Job 16:21
- v4 — Job 13:18
- v8 — Ps 10:1; Job 9:11; 1 Tim 6:16; Job 35:14
- v10 — Jas 1:12; Jas 1:2-4; 1 Pet 1:7; Ps 139:1-3; Ps 66:10
- v11 — Ps 44:18; 2 Pet 2:20-22; Rom 2:7; Ps 17:5; Ps 125:5
- v12 — Jer 15:16; Ps 119:11; Ps 119:103; John 4:34; Ps 19:9-10
- v13 — Ps 115:3; Prov 19:21; Dan 4:35; Isa 46:10; Eccl 3:14
- v14 — 1 Thess 3:3; 1 Thess 5:9; Ps 77:19; Ps 97:2; Rom 11:33
- v15 — Ps 119:120
- v16 — Ps 22:14; Job 27:2
- v17 — Job 19:8

Chapter 24

Job asks why the Almighty does not set times of judgment for the wicked. He describes the suffering of the poor and oppressed while evildoers murder, steal, and exploit without being called to account, thriving like grass before they are cut off.

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| <p>1 <i>Why, seeing times are not hidden from the Almighty, do they that know him not see his days?</i></p> | <p>"Why, seeing times are not hidden from the Almighty, do they that know Him not see His days?</p> |
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| 2 <i>Some remove the landmarks; they violently take away flocks, and feed thereof.</i> | Some remove the landmarks; they violently take away flocks, and feed of them. |
| 3 <i>They drive away the ass of the fatherless, they take the widow's ox for a pledge.</i> | They drive away the ass of the fatherless; they take the widow's ox for a pledge. |
| 4 <i>They turn the needy out of the way: the poor of the earth hide themselves together.</i> | They turn the needy out of the way; the poor of the earth hide themselves together. |
| 5 <i>Behold, as wild asses in the desert, go they forth to their work; rising betimes for a prey: the wilderness yieldeth food for them and for their children.</i> | Like wild asses in the desert, they go forth to their work, rising early for a prey; the wilderness yields food for them and for their children. |
| 6 <i>They reap every one his corn in the field: and they gather the vintage of the wicked.</i> | They reap each his corn in the field; and they gather the vintage of the wicked. |
| 7 <i>They cause the naked to lodge without clothing, that they have no covering in the cold.</i> | They cause the naked to lodge without clothing, that they have no covering in the cold. |
| 8 <i>They are wet with the showers of the mountains, and embrace the rock for want of a shelter.</i> | They are wet with the showers of the mountains, and embrace the rock for lack of a shelter. |
| 9 <i>They pluck the fatherless from the breast, and take a pledge of the poor.</i> | They pluck the fatherless from the breast, and take a pledge of the poor. |
| 10 <i>They cause him to go naked without clothing, and they take away the sheaf from the hungry;</i> | They cause him to go naked without clothing, and they take away the sheaf from the hungry; |
| 11 <i>Which make oil within their walls, and tread their winepresses, and suffer thirst.</i> | who make oil within their walls, and tread their winepresses, and suffer thirst. |
| 12 <i>Men groan from out of the city, and the soul of the wounded crieth out: yet God layeth not folly to them.</i> | Men groan from out of the city, and the soul of the wounded cries out; yet God lays not folly to them. |

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| 13 <i>They are of those that rebel against the light; they know not the ways thereof, nor abide in the paths thereof.</i> | They are of those that rebel against the light; they do not know the ways of it, nor abide in the paths of it. |
| 14 <i>The murderer rising with the light killeth the poor and needy, and in the night is as a thief.</i> | The murderer rising with the light kills the poor and needy, and in the night is as a thief. |
| 15 <i>The eye also of the adulterer waiteth for the twilight, saying, No eye shall see me: and disguiseth his face.</i> | The eye also of the adulterer waits for the twilight, saying, 'No eye shall see me'; and disguises his face. |
| 16 <i>In the dark they dig through houses, which they had marked for themselves in the daytime: they know not the light.</i> | In the dark they dig through houses, which they had marked for themselves in the daytime; they do not know the light. |
| 17 <i>For the morning is to them even as the shadow of death: if one know them, they are in the terrors of the shadow of death.</i> | For the morning is to them even as the shadow of death; if one know them, they are in the terrors of the shadow of death. |
| 18 <i>He is swift as the waters; their portion is cursed in the earth: he beholdeth not the way of the vineyards.</i> | He is swift as the waters; their portion is cursed in the earth; he does not see the way of the vineyards. |
| 19 <i>Drought and heat consume the snow waters: so doth the grave those which have sinned.</i> | Drought and heat consume the snow waters; so does the grave those which have sinned. |
| 20 <i>The womb shall forget him; the worm shall feed sweetly on him; he shall be no more remembered; and wickedness shall be broken as a tree.</i> | The womb shall forget him; the worm shall feed sweetly on him; he shall be no more remembered; and wickedness shall be broken as a tree. |
| 21 <i>He evil entreateth the barren that beareth not: and doeth not good to the widow.</i> | He evil entreats the barren that bears not, and does not good to the widow. |
| 22 <i>He draweth also the mighty with his power: he riseth up, and no man is sure of life.</i> | He draws also the mighty with his power; he rises up, and no man is sure of life. |

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| <p>23 <i>Though it be given him to be in safety, whereon he resteth; yet his eyes are upon their ways.</i></p> <p>24 <i>They are exalted for a little while, but are gone and brought low; they are taken out of the way as all other, and cut off as the tops of the ears of corn.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And if it be not so now, who will make me a liar, and make my speech nothing worth?</i></p> | <p>Though it be given him to be in safety, on which he rests, yet his eyes are on their ways.</p> <p>They are exalted for a little while, but are gone and brought low; they are taken out of the way as all others, and cut off as the tops of the ears of corn.</p> <p>And if it be not so now, who will make me a liar, and make my speech nothing worth?"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 1:7; Eccl 3:17; Eccl 8:6-7; 2 Pet 3:7-8
- v2 — Deut 27:17; Deut 19:14; Prov 23:10
- v4 — Prov 28:28
- v7 — Ex 22:26-27; Job 22:6
- v13 — John 3:19-20; Prov 4:19; Jude 1:6; 2 Thess 2:10-12
- v15 — Ps 10:11
- v16 — John 3:20
- v20 — Prov 10:7; Dan 4:14
- v23 — Prov 15:3
- v24 — Ps 37:10

Chapter 25

Bildad delivers his third and briefest speech, declaring that dominion and fear belong to God. He argues that no man born of woman can be clean before God, since even the moon and stars are not pure in His sight.

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| <p>1 <i>Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Dominion and fear are with him, he maketh peace in his high places.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Is there any number of his armies? and upon whom doth not his light arise?</i></p> | <p>Then Bildad the Shuhite answered and said:</p> <p>"Dominion and fear are with him; he makes peace in his high places.</p> <p>Is there any number of his armies? And on whom does his light not arise?</p> |
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| <p>4 <i>How then can man be justified with God? or how can he be clean that is born of a woman?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Behold even to the moon, and it shineth not; yea, the stars are not pure in his sight.</i></p> <p>6 <i>How much less man, that is a worm? and the son of man, which is a worm?</i></p> | <p>How then can man be justified with God? Or how can He be clean that is born of a woman?</p> <p>See, even to the moon, and it shines not; yes, the stars are not pure in his sight.</p> <p>How much less man, that is a worm? And the son of man, which is a worm?"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v3 — Jas 1:17

v4 — Rom 5:1; Ps 130:3; Job 4:17-19; Job 9:2; Job 15:14-16

v5 — Isa 60:19-20; Job 15:15

v6 — Isa 41:14; Ps 22:6

Chapter 26

Job responds with a rebuke, asking how Bildad has helped the powerless. He then exalts God's majesty, describing how God hangs the earth on nothing, stretches out the north over the empty place, and commands the sea -- yet these are only the edges of His ways.

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| <p>1 <i>But Job answered and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>How hast thou helped him that is without power? how savest thou the arm that hath no strength?</i></p> <p>3 <i>How hast thou counselled him that hath no wisdom? and how hast thou plentifully declared the thing as it is?</i></p> <p>4 <i>To whom hast thou uttered words? and whose spirit came from thee?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Dead things are formed from under the waters, and the inhabitants thereof.</i></p> | <p>But Job answered and said:</p> <p>"How have you helped him that is without power? How save you the arm that has no strength?</p> <p>How have you counselled him that has no wisdom? And how have you plentifully declared the thing as it is?</p> <p>To whom have you uttered words? And whose spirit came from you?</p> <p>Dead things are formed from under the waters, and the inhabitants of them.</p> |
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6	<i>Hell is naked before him, and destruction hath no covering.</i>	Hell is naked before him, and destruction has no covering.
7	<i>He stretcheth out the north over the empty place, and hangeth the earth upon nothing.</i>	He stretches out the north over the empty place, and hangs the earth on nothing.
8	<i>He bindeth up the waters in his thick clouds; and the cloud is not rent under them.</i>	He binds up the waters in his thick clouds; and the cloud is not torn under them.
9	<i>He holdeth back the face of his throne, and spreadeth his cloud upon it.</i>	He holds back the face of his throne, and spreads his cloud on it.
10	<i>He hath compassed the waters with bounds, until the day and night come to an end.</i>	He has compassed the waters with bounds, until the day and night come to an end.
11	<i>The pillars of heaven tremble and are astonished at his reproof.</i>	The pillars of heaven tremble and are astonished at his reproof.
12	<i>He divideth the sea with his power, and by his understanding he smiteth through the proud.</i>	He divides the sea with his power, and by his understanding he strikes through the proud.
13	<i>By his spirit he hath garnished the heavens; his hand hath formed the crooked serpent.</i>	By his spirit he has adorned the heavens; his hand has formed the crooked serpent.
14	<i>Lo, these are parts of his ways: but how little a portion is heard of him? but the thunder of his power who can understand?</i>	These are parts of his ways; but how little a portion is heard of him? But the thunder of his power who can understand?"

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v4 — 1 Kgs 22:23-24; Eccl 12:7; Job 20:3; 1 John 4:1-3; 1 Cor 12:3

v6 — Ps 139:8; Prov 15:11; Heb 4:13

v7 — Job 9:8; Ps 104:2-5; Isa 40:22; Isa 42:5; Prov 8:23-27

v8 — Prov 30:4; Job 37:11-16; Jer 10:13; Isa 5:6

v9 — Ps 97:2

v10 — Prov 8:29; Job 38:8-11; Jer 5:22

v11 — 1 Sam 2:8

v12 — Isa 51:15; Jer 31:35; Job 12:13; Job 9:13; Isa 51:9

v13 — Isa 27:1; Ps 104:30

v14 — Isa 40:26-29; Rom 11:33; Job 11:7-9; Ps 145:3; Ps 139:6

Chapter 27

Job swears by the living God that he will not remove his integrity and will hold fast his righteousness. He describes the hopeless end of the hypocrite, declaring that God will strip the wicked of their treasures and drive them away with a tempest.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover Job continued his parable, and said,</i></p> | Moreover Job continued his parable and said: |
| <p>2 <i>As God liveth, who hath taken away my judgment; and the Almighty, who hath vexed my soul;</i></p> | "As God lives, who has taken away my judgment; and the Almighty, Who has vexed my soul; |
| <p>3 <i>All the while my breath is in me, and the spirit of God is in my nostrils;</i></p> | all the while my breath is in me, and the spirit of God is in my nostrils, |
| <p>4 <i>My lips shall not speak wickedness, nor my tongue utter deceit.</i></p> | my lips shall not speak wickedness, nor my tongue utter deceit. |
| <p>5 <i>God forbid that I should justify you: till I die I will not remove mine integrity from me.</i></p> | God forbid that I should justify You; till I die I will not remove my integrity from me. |
| <p>6 <i>My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go: my heart shall not reproach me so long as I live.</i></p> | My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go; my heart shall not reproach me as long as I live. |
| <p>7 <i>Let mine enemy be as the wicked, and he that riseth up against me as the unrighteous.</i></p> | Let my enemy be as the wicked, and he that rises up against me as the unrighteous. |
| <p>8 <i>For what is the hope of the hypocrite, though he hath gained, when God taketh away his soul?</i></p> | For what is the hope of the hypocrite, though he has gained, when God takes away His soul? |
| <p>9 <i>Will God hear his cry when trouble cometh upon him?</i></p> | Will God hear His cry when trouble comes on Him? |

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| 10 | <i>Will he delight himself in the Almighty? will he always call upon God?</i> | Will He delight Himself in the Almighty? Will He always call on God? |
| 11 | <i>I will teach you by the hand of God: that which is with the Almighty will I not conceal.</i> | I will teach You by the hand of God; that which is with the Almighty I will not conceal. |
| 12 | <i>Behold, all ye yourselves have seen it; why then are ye thus altogether vain?</i> | See, all You yourselves have seen it; why then are You thus altogether vain? |
| 13 | <i>This is the portion of a wicked man with God, and the heritage of oppressors, which they shall receive of the Almighty.</i> | This is the portion of a wicked man with God, and the heritage of oppressors, which they shall receive of the Almighty. |
| 14 | <i>If his children be multiplied, it is for the sword: and his offspring shall not be satisfied with bread.</i> | If His children be multiplied, it is for the sword; and His offspring shall not be satisfied with bread. |
| 15 | <i>Those that remain of him shall be buried in death: and his widows shall not weep for them.</i> | Those that remain of Him shall be buried in death, and His widows shall not weep for them. |
| 16 | <i>Though he heap up silver as the dust, and prepare raiment as the clay;</i> | Though He heap up silver as the dust, and prepare raiment as the clay, |
| 17 | <i>He may prepare it, but the just shall put it on, and the innocent shall divide the silver.</i> | he may prepare it, but the just shall put it on, and the innocent shall divide the silver. |
| 18 | <i>He buildeth his house as a moth, and as a booth that the keeper maketh.</i> | He builds His house as a moth, and as a booth that the keeper makes. |
| 19 | <i>The rich man shall lie down, but he shall not be gathered: he openeth his eyes, and he is not.</i> | The rich man shall lie down, but he shall not be gathered; he opens his eyes, and he is not. |
| 20 | <i>Terrors take hold on him as waters, a tempest stealeth him away in the night.</i> | Terrors take hold on him as waters; a tempest steals him away in the night. |
| 21 | <i>The east wind carrieth him away, and he departeth: and as a storm hurleth him out of his place.</i> | The east wind carries him away, and he departs; and as a storm hurls him out of his place. |

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| 22 | <i>For God shall cast upon him, and not spare: he would fain flee out of his hand.</i> | For God shall cast on Him, and not spare; He would gladly flee out of His hand. |
| 23 | <i>Men shall clap their hands at him, and shall hiss him out of his place.</i> | Men shall clap their hands at him, and shall hiss him out of his place." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Job 34:5
- v3 — Gen 2:7; Job 33:4; Isa 2:22; Job 32:8
- v4 — Job 13:7; Job 6:28; John 8:55; Job 34:6; 2 Cor 11:10
- v5 — Job 2:9; Job 13:15
- v6 — Job 2:3; Acts 24:16; 1 John 3:20-21
- v8 — Matt 16:26
- v9 — Jer 14:12; Prov 1:28; Isa 1:15; Mic 3:4; Job 35:12-13
- v10 — Job 22:26-27; Ps 37:4
- v11 — Ps 71:17; Job 4:3-4; Isa 8:11
- v14 — Deut 28:41
- v17 — Prov 13:22; Prov 28:8; Eccl 2:26
- v18 — Isa 1:8; Job 8:14-15

Chapter 28

Job speaks a great poem on wisdom, declaring that man can mine silver and gold from the earth but cannot discover where wisdom dwells. It is hidden from the eyes of all living and cannot be purchased with gold or precious stones. God alone understands its way: "The fear of the Lord, that is wisdom."

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| 1 | <i>Surely there is a vein for the silver, and a place for gold where they fine it.</i> | "Surely there is a vein for the silver, and a place for gold where they refine it. |
| 2 | <i>Iron is taken out of the earth, and brass is molten out of the stone.</i> | Iron is taken out of the earth, and brass is melted out of the stone. |
| 3 | <i>He setteth an end to darkness, and searcheth out all perfection: the stones of darkness, and the shadow of death.</i> | He sets an end to darkness, and searches out all perfection — the stones of darkness, and the shadow of death. |

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| 4 <i>The flood breaketh out from the inhabitant; even the waters forgotten of the foot: they are dried up, they are gone away from men.</i> | The flood breaks out from the inhabitant; even the waters forgotten of the foot; they are dried up, they are gone away from men. |
| 5 <i>As for the earth, out of it cometh bread: and under it is turned up as it were fire.</i> | As for the earth, out of it comes bread; and under it is turned up as it were fire. |
| 6 <i>The stones of it are the place of sapphires: and it hath dust of gold.</i> | The stones of it are the place of sapphires; and it has dust of gold. |
| 7 <i>There is a path which no fowl knoweth, and which the vulture's eye hath not seen:</i> | There is a path which no fowl knows, and which the vulture's eye has not seen. |
| 8 <i>The lion's whelps have not trodden it, nor the fierce lion passed by it.</i> | The lion's whelps have not trodden it, nor the fierce lion passed by it. |
| 9 <i>He putteth forth his hand upon the rock; he overturneth the mountains by the roots.</i> | He puts forth his hand on the rock; he overturns the mountains by the roots. |
| 10 <i>He cutteth out rivers among the rocks; and his eye seeth every precious thing.</i> | He cuts out rivers among the rocks; and his eye sees every precious thing. |
| 11 <i>He bindeth the floods from overflowing; and the thing that is hid bringeth he forth to light.</i> | He binds the floods from overflowing; and the thing that is hidden he brings forth to light. |
| 12 <i>But where shall wisdom be found? and where is the place of understanding?</i> | But where shall wisdom be found? And where is the place of understanding? |
| 13 <i>Man knoweth not the price thereof; neither is it found in the land of the living.</i> | Man does not know the price of it; neither is it found in the land of the living. |
| 14 <i>The depth saith, It is not in me: and the sea saith, It is not with me.</i> | The depth says, 'It is not in me'; and the sea says, 'It is not with me.' |
| 15 <i>It cannot be gotten for gold, neither shall silver be weighed for the price thereof.</i> | It cannot be gotten for gold, neither shall silver be weighed for the price of it. |

- 16 *It cannot be valued with the gold of Ophir, with the precious onyx, or the sapphire.* It cannot be valued with the gold of Ophir, with the precious onyx, or the sapphire.
- 17 *The gold and the crystal cannot equal it: and the exchange of it shall not be for jewels of fine gold.* The gold and the crystal cannot equal it; and the exchange of it shall not be for jewels of fine gold.
- 18 *No mention shall be made of coral, or of pearls: for the price of wisdom is above rubies.* No mention shall be made of coral, or of pearls; for the price of wisdom is above rubies.
- 19 *The topaz of Ethiopia shall not equal it, neither shall it be valued with pure gold.* The topaz of Ethiopia shall not equal it, neither shall it be valued with pure gold.
- 20 *Whence then cometh wisdom? and where is the place of understanding?* From where then comes wisdom? And where is the place of understanding?
- 21 *Seeing it is hid from the eyes of all living, and kept close from the fowls of the air.* Seeing it is hidden from the eyes of all living, and kept close from the fowls of the air.
- 22 *Destruction and death say, We have heard the fame thereof with our ears.* Destruction and death say, 'We have heard the fame of it with our ears.'
- 23 *God understandeth the way thereof, and he knoweth the place thereof.* God understands the way of it, and He knows the place of it.
- 24 *For he looketh to the ends of the earth, and seeth under the whole heaven;* For he looks to the ends of the earth, and sees under the whole heaven;
- 25 *To make the weight for the winds; and he weigheth the waters by measure.* to make the weight for the winds; and he weighs the waters by measure.
- 26 *When he made a decree for the rain, and a way for the lightning of the thunder:* When he made a decree for the rain, and a way for the lightning of the thunder,
- 27 *Then did he see it, and declare it; he prepared it, yea, and searched it out.* then he saw it, and declared it; he prepared it, yes, and searched it out.

- 28 *And unto man he said, Behold, the fear of the LORD, that is wisdom; and to depart from evil is understanding.* And to man he said, 'See, the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom; and to depart from evil is understanding.' "

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 8:9
 v7 — Job 11:6
 v12 — Jas 1:5; Job 28:20; Prov 2:4-6; Prov 3:19; Col 2:3
 v15 — Prov 16:16
 v18 — Prov 3:15
 v20 — Job 28:12; Job 28:28; Jas 1:17; Jas 1:5
 v21 — Ps 49:3-4; Matt 11:25; 1 Cor 2:7-10; Col 2:3
 v23 — Prov 8:22-31; 1 Cor 1:30; Jude 1:25; Rom 11:33
 v24 — Prov 15:3
 v25 — Ps 135:7
 v26 — Job 38:25; Job 37:3
 v28 — Ps 111:10; Prov 1:7; Prov 9:10; Prov 3:7; Eccl 12:13

Chapter 29

Job recalls the days of his former glory when God's candle shone on his head, when he sat as chief in the gate, and when the young men hid themselves and the aged arose in respect. He remembers how he delivered the poor, was eyes to the blind, and expected to die in comfort.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover Job continued his parable, and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Oh that I were as in months past, as in the days when God preserved me;</i></p> <p>3 <i>When his candle shined upon my head, and when by his light I walked through darkness;</i></p> <p>4 <i>As I was in the days of my youth, when the secret of God was upon my tabernacle;</i></p> <p>5 <i>When the Almighty was yet with me, when my children were about me;</i></p> | <p>Moreover Job continued his parable and said:</p> <p>"Oh that I were as in months past, as in the days when God preserved me;</p> <p>when his candle shined on my head, and when by his light I walked through darkness;</p> <p>as I was in the days of my youth, when the secret of God was on my tabernacle;</p> <p>when the Almighty was yet with me, when my children were about me;</p> |
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| 6 | <i>When I washed my steps with butter,
and the rock poured me out rivers of
oil;</i> | when I washed my steps with butter,
and the rock poured me out rivers of
oil; |
| 7 | <i>When I went out to the gate through
the city, when I prepared my seat in
the street!</i> | when I went out to the gate through the
city, when I prepared my seat in the
street! |
| 8 | <i>The young men saw me, and hid
themselves; and the aged arose, and
stood up.</i> | The young men saw me, and hid
themselves; and the aged arose, and
stood up. |
| 9 | <i>The princes refrained talking, and
laid their hand on their mouth.</i> | The princes refrained talking, and laid
their hand on their mouth. |
| 10 | <i>The nobles held their peace, and their
tongue cleaved to the roof of their
mouth.</i> | The nobles held their peace, and their
tongue clung to the roof of their
mouth. |
| 11 | <i>When the ear heard me, then it
blessed me; and when the eye saw me,
it gave witness to me:</i> | When the ear heard me, then it blessed
me; and when the eye saw me, it gave
witness to me; |
| 12 | <i>Because I delivered the poor that
cried, and the fatherless, and him that
had none to help him.</i> | because I delivered the poor that cried,
and the fatherless, and Him that had
none to help Him. |
| 13 | <i>The blessing of him that was ready to
perish came upon me; and I caused
the widow's heart to sing for joy.</i> | The blessing of Him that was ready to
perish came on me; and I caused the
widow's heart to sing for joy. |
| 14 | <i>I put on righteousness, and it clothed
me: my judgment was as a robe and a
diadem.</i> | I put on righteousness, and it clothed
me; my judgment was as a robe and a
diadem. |
| 15 | <i>I was eyes to the blind, and feet was I
to the lame.</i> | I was eyes to the blind, and feet was I
to the lame. |
| 16 | <i>I was a father to the poor: and the
cause which I knew not I searched
out.</i> | I was a father to the poor; and the
cause which I did not know I searched
out. |
| 17 | <i>And I brake the jaws of the wicked,
and plucked the spoil out of his teeth.</i> | And I broke the jaws of the wicked,
and plucked the spoil out of his teeth. |

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| <p>18 <i>Then I said, I shall die in my nest, and I shall multiply my days as the sand.</i></p> <p>19 <i>My root was spread out by the waters, and the dew lay all night upon my branch.</i></p> <p>20 <i>My glory was fresh in me, and my bow was renewed in mine hand.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Unto me men gave ear, and waited, and kept silence at my counsel.</i></p> <p>22 <i>After my words they spake not again; and my speech dropped upon them.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And they waited for me as for the rain; and they opened their mouth wide as for the latter rain.</i></p> <p>24 <i>If I laughed on them, they believed it not; and the light of my countenance they cast not down.</i></p> <p>25 <i>I chose out their way, and sat chief, and dwelt as a king in the army, as one that comforteth the mourners.</i></p> | <p>Then I said, 'I shall die in my nest, and I shall multiply my days as the sand.</p> <p>My root was spread out by the waters, and the dew lay all night on my branch.</p> <p>My glory was fresh in me, and my bow was renewed in my hand.'</p> <p>To me men gave ear, and waited, and kept silence at my counsel.</p> <p>After my words they spoke not again; and my speech dropped on them.</p> <p>And they waited for me as for the rain; and they opened their mouth wide as for the latter rain.</p> <p>If I laughed on them, they did not believe it; and the light of my countenance they cast not down.</p> <p>I chose out their way, and sat chief, and lived as a king in the army, as one that comforts the mourners."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 27:1
- v3 — Ps 18:28; John 8:12; John 12:46; Eph 5:8; Job 18:6
- v4 — Ps 25:14; Prov 3:32
- v6 — Ps 81:16; Job 20:17; Deut 32:13-14; Deut 33:24
- v9 — Job 21:5
- v12 — Ps 72:12; Prov 21:13
- v14 — Isa 61:10; Isa 59:17; Ps 132:9; Eph 6:14; Job 27:6
- v16 — Prov 29:7
- v17 — Ps 3:7; Prov 30:14
- v19 — Jer 17:8; Ps 1:3
- v20 — Gen 49:24; Isa 40:31
- v22 — Deut 32:2

Chapter 30

Job contrasts his present humiliation with his former honor. Those younger than he now mock him, the outcasts make him their byword, and God has cast him into the mire. He cries out to God but receives no answer; his skin is black and his bones burn with fever.

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| 1 <i>But now they that are younger than I have me in derision, whose fathers I would have disdained to have set with the dogs of my flock.</i> | "But now they that are younger than I have me in derision, whose fathers I would have disdained to have set with the dogs of my flock. |
| 2 <i>Yea, whereto might the strength of their hands profit me, in whom old age was perished?</i> | Yes, where to might the strength of their hands profit me, in whom old age was perished? |
| 3 <i>For want and famine they were solitary; fleeing into the wilderness in former time desolate and waste.</i> | For want and famine they were solitary, fleeing into the wilderness in former time desolate and waste. |
| 4 <i>Who cut up mallows by the bushes, and juniper roots for their meat.</i> | Who cut up mallows by the bushes, and juniper roots for their meat. |
| 5 <i>They were driven forth from among men, (they cried after them as after a thief;)</i> | They were driven forth from among men (they cried after them as after a thief), |
| 6 <i>To dwell in the clefts of the valleys, in caves of the earth, and in the rocks.</i> | to live in the clefts of the valleys, in caves of the earth, and in the rocks. |
| 7 <i>Among the bushes they brayed; under the nettles they were gathered together.</i> | Among the bushes they brayed; under the nettles they were gathered together. |
| 8 <i>They were children of fools, yea, children of base men: they were viler than the earth.</i> | They were children of fools, yes, children of base men; they were viler than the earth. |
| 9 <i>And now am I their song, yea, I am their byword.</i> | And now I am their song, yes, I am their byword. |
| 10 <i>They abhor me, they flee far from me, and spare not to spit in my face.</i> | They abhor me, they flee far from me, and spare not to spit in my face. |
| 11 <i>Because he hath loosed my cord, and afflicted me, they have also let loose the bridle before me.</i> | Because he has loosed my cord, and afflicted me, they have also let loose the bridle before me. |

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| 12 <i>Upon my right hand rise the youth;
they push away my feet, and they raise
up against me the ways of their
destruction.</i> | On my right hand rise the youth; they
push away my feet, and they raise up
against me the ways of their
destruction. |
| 13 <i>They mar my path, they set forward
my calamity, they have no helper.</i> | They mar my path, they set forward
my calamity, they have no helper. |
| 14 <i>They came upon me as a wide
breaking in of waters: in the
desolation they rolled themselves
upon me.</i> | They came on me as a wide breaking
in of waters; in the desolation they
rolled themselves on me. |
| 15 <i>Terrors are turned upon me: they
pursue my soul as the wind: and my
welfare passeth away as a cloud.</i> | Terrors are turned on me; they pursue
my soul as the wind, and my welfare
passes away as a cloud. |
| 16 <i>And now my soul is poured out upon
me; the days of affliction have taken
hold upon me.</i> | And now my soul is poured out on me;
the days of affliction have taken hold
on me. |
| 17 <i>My bones are pierced in me in the
night season: and my sinews take no
rest.</i> | My bones are pierced in me in the
night season, and my sinews take no
rest. |
| 18 <i>By the great force of my disease is my
garment changed: it bindeth me about
as the collar of my coat.</i> | By the great force of my disease is my
garment changed; it binds me about as
the collar of my coat. |
| 19 <i>He hath cast me into the mire, and I
am become like dust and ashes.</i> | He has cast me into the mire, and I
have become like dust and ashes. |
| 20 <i>I cry unto thee, and thou dost not hear
me: I stand up, and thou regardest me
not.</i> | I cry to you, and you do not hear me; I
stand up, and you do not regard me. |
| 21 <i>Thou art become cruel to me: with thy
strong hand thou opposest thyself
against me.</i> | You have become cruel to me; with
your strong hand you oppose yourself
against me. |
| 22 <i>Thou liftest me up to the wind; thou
causest me to ride upon it, and
dissolvest my substance.</i> | You lift me up to the wind; you cause
me to ride on it, and dissolve my
substance. |

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| <p>23 <i>For I know that thou wilt bring me to death, and to the house appointed for all living.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Howbeit he will not stretch out his hand to the grave, though they cry in his destruction.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Did not I weep for him that was in trouble? was not my soul grieved for the poor?</i></p> <p>26 <i>When I looked for good, then evil came unto me: and when I waited for light, there came darkness.</i></p> <p>27 <i>My bowels boiled, and rested not: the days of affliction prevented me.</i></p> <p>28 <i>I went mourning without the sun: I stood up, and I cried in the congregation.</i></p> <p>29 <i>I am a brother to dragons, and a companion to owls.</i></p> <p>30 <i>My skin is black upon me, and my bones are burned with heat.</i></p> <p>31 <i>My harp also is turned to mourning, and my organ into the voice of them that weep.</i></p> | <p>For I know that you will bring me to death, and to the house appointed for all living.</p> <p>However he will not stretch out his hand to the grave, though they cry in his destruction.</p> <p>Did I not weep for him that was in trouble? Was not my soul grieved for the poor?</p> <p>When I looked for good, then evil came to me; and when I waited for light, there came darkness.</p> <p>My bowels boiled, and did not rest; the days of affliction prevented me.</p> <p>I went mourning without the sun; I stood up, and I cried in the congregation.</p> <p>I am a brother to dragons, and a companion to owls.</p> <p>My skin is black on me, and my bones are burned with heat.</p> <p>My harp also is turned to mourning, and my organ into the voice of them that weep."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 12:4
- v9 — Job 17:6; Lam 3:63; Lam 3:14
- v10 — Matt 26:67; Isa 50:6; Ps 88:8; Num 12:14
- v12 — Job 19:12
- v15 — Hos 13:3
- v16 — Ps 42:4
- v25 — Rom 12:15; Ps 35:13-14
- v26 — Jer 8:15; Job 3:25-26; Jer 14:19

v28 — Ps 38:6; Ps 42:9; Ps 43:2

v29 — Mic 1:8; Ps 102:6

v30 — Lam 4:8; Ps 102:3; Ps 119:83

v31 — Lam 5:15

Chapter 31

Job delivers his final oath of innocence, swearing that he has not lusted, lied, oppressed the poor, trusted in gold, or worshipped the sun and moon. He calls for God to answer him and signs his defense, wishing his adversary had written a book.

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| 1 | <i>I made a covenant with mine eyes; why then should I think upon a maid?</i> | "I made a covenant with my eyes; why then should I think on a maid? |
| 2 | <i>For what portion of God is there from above? and what inheritance of the Almighty from on high?</i> | For what portion of God is there from above? And what inheritance of the Almighty from on high? |
| 3 | <i>Is not destruction to the wicked? and a strange punishment to the workers of iniquity?</i> | Is not destruction to the wicked? And a strange punishment to the workers of iniquity? |
| 4 | <i>Doth not he see my ways, and count all my steps?</i> | Does he not see my ways, and count all my steps? |
| 5 | <i>If I have walked with vanity, or if my foot hath hasted to deceit;</i> | If I have walked with vanity, or if my foot has hastened to deceit, |
| 6 | <i>Let me be weighed in an even balance, that God may know mine integrity.</i> | let me be weighed in an even balance, that God may know my integrity. |
| 7 | <i>If my step hath turned out of the way, and mine heart walked after mine eyes, and if any blot hath cleaved to mine hands;</i> | If my step has turned out of the way, and my heart walked after my eyes, and if any blot has clung to my hands, |
| 8 | <i>Then let me sow, and let another eat; yea, let my offspring be rooted out.</i> | then let me sow, and let another eat; yes, let my offspring be rooted out. |
| 9 | <i>If mine heart have been deceived by a woman, or if I have laid wait at my neighbour's door;</i> | If my heart has been deceived by a woman, or if I have lain in wait at my neighbour's door, |
| 10 | <i>Then let my wife grind unto another, and let others bow down upon her.</i> | then let my wife grind to another, and let others bow down on her. |

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| <p>11 <i>For this is an heinous crime; yea, it is an iniquity to be punished by the judges.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For it is a fire that consumeth to destruction, and would root out all mine increase.</i></p> <p>13 <i>If I did despise the cause of my manservant or of my maidservant, when they contended with me;</i></p> <p>14 <i>What then shall I do when God riseth up? and when he visiteth, what shall I answer him?</i></p> <p>15 <i>Did not he that made me in the womb make him? and did not one fashion us in the womb?</i></p> <p>16 <i>If I have withheld the poor from their desire, or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail;</i></p> <p>17 <i>Or have eaten my morsel myself alone, and the fatherless hath not eaten thereof;</i></p> <p>18 <i>(For from my youth he was brought up with me, as with a father, and I have guided her from my mother's womb;)</i></p> <p>19 <i>If I have seen any perish for want of clothing, or any poor without covering;</i></p> <p>20 <i>If his loins have not blessed me, and if he were not warmed with the fleece of my sheep;</i></p> <p>21 <i>If I have lifted up my hand against the fatherless, when I saw my help in the gate:</i></p> | <p>For this is a heinous crime; yes, it is an iniquity to be punished by the judges.</p> <p>For it is a fire that consumes to destruction, and would root out all my increase.</p> <p>If I despised the cause of my manservant or of my maidservant, when they contended with me;</p> <p>what then shall I do when God rises up? And when He visits, what shall I answer Him?</p> <p>Did not he that made me in the womb make him? And did not one fashion us in the womb?</p> <p>If I have withheld the poor from their desire, or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail;</p> <p>or have eaten my morsel myself alone, and the fatherless has not eaten of it;</p> <p>(for from my youth he was brought up with me, as with a father, and I have guided her from my mother's womb);</p> <p>if I have seen any perish for lack of clothing, or any poor without covering;</p> <p>if his loins have not blessed me, and if he were not warmed with the fleece of my sheep;</p> <p>if I have lifted up my hand against the fatherless, when I saw my help in the gate,</p> |
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- 22 *Then let mine arm fall from my shoulder blade, and mine arm be broken from the bone.* then let my arm fall from my shoulder blade, and my arm be broken from the bone.
- 23 *For destruction from God was a terror to me, and by reason of his highness I could not endure.* For destruction from God was a terror to me, and by reason of His highness I could not endure.
- 24 *If I have made gold my hope, or have said to the fine gold, Thou art my confidence;* If I have made gold my hope, or have said to the fine gold, 'You are my confidence';
- 25 *If I rejoiced because my wealth was great, and because mine hand had gotten much;* if I rejoiced because my wealth was great, and because my hand had gotten much;
- 26 *If I beheld the sun when it shined, or the moon walking in brightness;* if I beheld the sun when it shined, or the moon walking in brightness;
- 27 *And my heart hath been secretly enticed, or my mouth hath kissed my hand:* and my heart has been secretly enticed, or my mouth has kissed my hand;
- 28 *This also were an iniquity to be punished by the judge: for I should have denied the God that is above.* this also were an iniquity to be punished by the judge; for I should have denied the God that is above.
- 29 *If I rejoiced at the destruction of him that hated me, or lifted up myself when evil found him:* If I rejoiced at the destruction of him that hated me, or lifted up myself when evil found him;
- 30 *Neither have I suffered my mouth to sin by wishing a curse to his soul.* neither have I allowed my mouth to sin by wishing a curse to his soul.
- 31 *If the men of my tabernacle said not, Oh that we had of his flesh! we cannot be satisfied.* If the men of my tabernacle did not say, 'Oh that we had of his flesh! We cannot be satisfied';
- 32 *The stranger did not lodge in the street: but I opened my doors to the traveller.* the stranger did not lodge in the street; but I opened my doors to the traveller.
- 33 *If I covered my transgressions as Adam, by hiding mine iniquity in my bosom:* If I covered my transgressions as Adam, by hiding my iniquity in my bosom,

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| <p>34 <i>Did I fear a great multitude, or did the contempt of families terrify me, that I kept silence, and went not out of the door?</i></p> <p>35 <i>Oh that one would hear me! behold, my desire is, that the Almighty would answer me, and that mine adversary had written a book.</i></p> <p>36 <i>Surely I would take it upon my shoulder, and bind it as a crown to me.</i></p> <p>37 <i>I would declare unto him the number of my steps; as a prince would I go near unto him.</i></p> <p>38 <i>If my land cry against me, or that the furrows likewise thereof complain;</i></p> <p>39 <i>If I have eaten the fruits thereof without money, or have caused the owners thereof to lose their life:</i></p> <p>40 <i>Let thistles grow instead of wheat, and cockle instead of barley. The words of Job are ended.</i></p> | <p>did I fear a great multitude, or did the contempt of families terrify me, that I kept silence, and went not out of the door?</p> <p>Oh that one would hear me! See, my desire is, that the Almighty would answer me, and that my adversary had written a book.</p> <p>Surely I would take it on my shoulder, and bind it as a crown to me.</p> <p>I would declare to Him the number of my steps; as a prince would I go near to Him.</p> <p>If my land cries against me, or that the furrows likewise of it complain;</p> <p>if I have eaten the fruits of it without money, or have caused the owners of it to lose their life;</p> <p>let thistles grow instead of wheat, and cockle instead of barley." The words of Job are ended.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jas 1:14-15; Matt 5:28-29; 1 John 2:16; Ps 119:37; Prov 6:25
- v4 — Job 34:21; Prov 5:21; 2 Chr 16:9; Job 14:16; Prov 15:3
- v6 — Dan 5:27; Ps 7:8-9; 1 Sam 2:3; Matt 7:23; Isa 26:7
- v8 — Mic 6:15; Lev 26:16
- v11 — Lev 20:10
- v15 — Prov 14:31; Prov 22:2; Mal 2:10; Job 34:19
- v23 — Job 13:11; Ps 119:120
- v26 — Ezek 8:16; Deut 4:19
- v28 — Deut 17:2-7; Job 31:11
- v29 — Prov 24:17-18; Prov 17:5
- v32 — Heb 13:2; Gen 19:2-3

v33 — Prov 28:13; Acts 5:8; Gen 3:12; Hos 6:7; 1 John 1:8-10

Chapter 32

The three friends fell silent, and the young Elihu the son of Barachel burned with anger -- against Job for justifying himself rather than God, and against the friends for condemning Job without answer. Elihu declares he can no longer hold back and must speak what the Spirit within him compels.

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| 1 | <i>So these three men ceased to answer Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes.</i> | So these three men ceased to answer Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes. |
| 2 | <i>Then was kindled the wrath of Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite, of the kindred of Ram: against Job was his wrath kindled, because he justified himself rather than God.</i> | Then was kindled the wrath of Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite, of the family of Ram; against Job was his wrath kindled, because he justified himself rather than God. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elihu** (eh-LY-hoo) — "my God is He" — Son of Barachel the Buzite; young man who speaks after the three friends fall silent.

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| 3 | <i>Also against his three friends was his wrath kindled, because they had found no answer, and yet had condemned Job.</i> | Also against his three friends was his wrath kindled, because they had found no answer, and yet had condemned Job. |
| 4 | <i>Now Elihu had waited till Job had spoken, because they were elder than he.</i> | Now Elihu had waited till Job had spoken, because they were elder than he. |
| 5 | <i>When Elihu saw that there was no answer in the mouth of these three men, then his wrath was kindled.</i> | When Elihu saw that there was no answer in the mouth of these three men, then his wrath was kindled. |
| 6 | <i>And Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite answered and said, I am young, and ye are very old; wherefore I was afraid, and durst not shew you mine opinion.</i> | And Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite answered and said: "I am young, and you are very old; therefore I was afraid, and dared not show you my opinion. |
| 7 | <i>I said, Days should speak, and multitude of years should teach wisdom.</i> | I said, 'Days should speak, and multitude of years should teach wisdom.' |

- 8 *But there is a spirit in man: and the inspiration of the Almighty giveth them understanding.* But there is a spirit in man; and the inspiration of the Almighty gives them understanding.
- 9 *Great men are not always wise: neither do the aged understand judgment.* Great men are not always wise; neither do the aged understand judgment.
- 10 *Therefore I said, Hearken to me; I also will shew mine opinion.* Therefore I said, 'Listen to me; I also will show my opinion.'
- 11 *Behold, I waited for your words; I gave ear to your reasons, whilst ye searched out what to say.* See, I waited for Your words; I gave ear to Your reasons, while You searched out what to say.
- 12 *Yea, I attended unto you, and, behold, there was none of you that convinced Job, or that answered his words:* Yes, I attended to you, and, see, there was none of you that convinced Job, or that answered his words,
- 13 *Lest ye should say, We have found out wisdom: God thrusteth him down, not man.* lest you should say, 'We have found out wisdom; God thrusts Him down, not man.'
- 14 *Now he hath not directed his words against me: neither will I answer him with your speeches.* Now he has not directed his words against me; neither will I answer him with your speeches.
- 15 *They were amazed, they answered no more: they left off speaking.* They were amazed, they answered no more; they left off speaking.
- 16 *When I had waited, (for they spake not, but stood still, and answered no more;)* When I had waited (for they did not speak, but stood still, and answered no more),
- 17 *I said, I will answer also my part, I also will shew mine opinion.* I said, 'I will answer also my part; I also will show my opinion.'
- 18 *For I am full of matter, the spirit within me constraineth me.* For I am full of matter; the spirit within me constrains me.
- 19 *Behold, my belly is as wine which hath no vent; it is ready to burst like new bottles.* See, my belly is as wine which has no vent; it is ready to burst like new bottles.

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| 20 | <i>I will speak, that I may be refreshed: I will open my lips and answer.</i> | <i>I will speak, that I may be refreshed; I will open my lips and answer.</i> |
| 21 | <i>Let me not, I pray you, accept any man's person, neither let me give flattering titles unto man.</i> | <i>Let me not, I pray you, accept any man's person, neither let me give flattering titles to man.</i> |
| 22 | <i>For I know not to give flattering titles; in so doing my maker would soon take me away.</i> | <i>For I know not to give flattering titles; in so doing my Maker would soon take me away.</i> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 10:7; Job 33:9
- v2 — Gen 22:21
- v6 — Job 15:10; 1 Tim 5:1
- v7 — Prov 16:31; Job 12:12
- v8 — Job 33:4; Job 38:36; 2 Tim 3:16; Prov 2:6; Jas 1:5
- v9 — Matt 11:25; Job 12:20; Eccl 4:13; 1 Cor 1:26-27
- v13 — Jer 9:23
- v18 — Ps 39:3
- v21 — Lev 19:15

Chapter 33

Elihu addresses Job directly, arguing that God speaks to man through dreams, visions, and pain on his bed to turn him from the pit. He describes a mediating angel who intercedes for the sufferer and declares that God redeems the soul to bring him back to the light of the living.

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| 1 | <i>Wherefore, Job, I pray thee, hear my speeches, and hearken to all my words.</i> | <i>"Therefore, Job, I pray you, hear my speeches, and listen to all my words.</i> |
| 2 | <i>Behold, now I have opened my mouth, my tongue hath spoken in my mouth.</i> | <i>See now, I have opened my mouth; my tongue has spoken in my mouth.</i> |
| 3 | <i>My words shall be of the uprightness of my heart: and my lips shall utter knowledge clearly.</i> | <i>My words shall be of the uprightness of my heart; and my lips shall utter knowledge clearly.</i> |

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| 4 <i>The Spirit of God hath made me, and the breath of the Almighty hath given me life.</i> | The Spirit of God has made me, and the breath of the Almighty has given me life. |
| 5 <i>If thou canst answer me, set thy words in order before me, stand up.</i> | If You can answer me, set Your words in order before me; stand up. |
| 6 <i>Behold, I am according to thy wish in God's stead: I also am formed out of the clay.</i> | See, I am according to Your wish in God's place; I also am formed out of the clay. |
| 7 <i>Behold, my terror shall not make thee afraid, neither shall my hand be heavy upon thee.</i> | See, my terror shall not make You afraid, neither shall my hand be heavy on You. |
| 8 <i>Surely thou hast spoken in mine hearing, and I have heard the voice of thy words, saying,</i> | Surely You have spoken in my hearing, and I have heard the voice of Your words, saying, |
| 9 <i>I am clean without transgression, I am innocent; neither is there iniquity in me.</i> | 'I am clean without transgression; I am innocent; neither is there iniquity in me. |
| 10 <i>Behold, he findeth occasions against me, he counteth me for his enemy,</i> | See, He finds occasions against me; He counts me for His enemy; |
| 11 <i>He putteth my feet in the stocks, he marketh all my paths.</i> | he puts my feet in the stocks; He marks all my paths.' |
| 12 <i>Behold, in this thou art not just: I will answer thee, that God is greater than man.</i> | See, in this You are not just; I will answer You, that God is greater than man. |
| 13 <i>Why dost thou strive against him? for he giveth not account of any of his matters.</i> | Why do You strive against Him? For He gives not account of any of His matters. |
| 14 <i>For God speaketh once, yea twice, yet man perceiveth it not.</i> | For God speaks once, yes twice, yet man perceives it not. |
| 15 <i>In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falleth upon men, in slumberings upon the bed;</i> | In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falls on men, in slumberings on the bed; |

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| 16 | <i>Then he openeth the ears of men, and sealeth their instruction,</i> | then He opens the ears of men, and seals their instruction, |
| 17 | <i>That he may withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man.</i> | that He may withdraw man from His purpose, and hide pride from man. |
| 18 | <i>He keepeth back his soul from the pit, and his life from perishing by the sword.</i> | He keeps back His soul from the pit, and His life from perishing by the sword. |
| 19 | <i>He is chastened also with pain upon his bed, and the multitude of his bones with strong pain:</i> | He is chastened also with pain on His bed, and the multitude of His bones with strong pain, |
| 20 | <i>So that his life abhorreth bread, and his soul dainty meat.</i> | so that His life abhors bread, and His soul dainty meat. |
| 21 | <i>His flesh is consumed away, that it cannot be seen; and his bones that were not seen stick out.</i> | His flesh is consumed away, that it cannot be seen; and His bones that were not seen stick out. |
| 22 | <i>Yea, his soul draweth near unto the grave, and his life to the destroyers.</i> | Yes, His soul draws near to the grave, and His life to the destroyers. |
| 23 | <i>If there be a messenger with him, an interpreter, one among a thousand, to shew unto man his uprightness:</i> | If there be a messenger with Him, an interpreter, one among a thousand, to show to man His uprightness, |
| 24 | <i>Then he is gracious unto him, and saith, Deliver him from going down to the pit: I have found a ransom.</i> | then He is gracious to Him, and says, 'Deliver Him from going down to the pit; I have found a ransom.' |
| 25 | <i>His flesh shall be fresher than a child's: he shall return to the days of his youth:</i> | His flesh shall be fresher than a child's; He shall return to the days of His youth. |
| 26 | <i>He shall pray unto God, and he will be favourable unto him: and he shall see his face with joy: for he will render unto man his righteousness.</i> | He shall pray to God, and He will be favourable to Him; and He shall see His face with joy; for He will render to man His righteousness. |
| 27 | <i>He looketh upon men, and if any say, I have sinned, and perverted that which was right, and it profited me not;</i> | He looks on men, and if any say, 'I have sinned, and perverted that which was right, and it did not profit me'; |

28	<i>He will deliver his soul from going into the pit, and his life shall see the light.</i>	he will deliver His soul from going into the pit, and His life shall see the light.
29	<i>Lo, all these things worketh God oftentimes with man,</i>	All these things God works often with man,
30	<i>To bring back his soul from the pit, to be enlightened with the light of the living.</i>	to bring back His soul from the pit, to be enlightened with the light of the living.
31	<i>Mark well, O Job, hearken unto me: hold thy peace, and I will speak.</i>	Mark well, O Job, listen to me; hold your peace, and I will speak.
32	<i>If thou hast any thing to say, answer me: speak, for I desire to justify thee.</i>	If you have any thing to say, answer me; speak, for I desire to justify you.
33	<i>If not, hearken unto me: hold thy peace, and I shall teach thee wisdom.</i>	If not, listen to me; hold your peace, and I shall teach you wisdom."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v4 — Job 32:8; Gen 2:7; Job 27:3; Job 10:12; 1 Cor 15:45
v9 — Job 10:7; Job 16:17
v13 — Job 40:2
v14 — Prov 1:24; 2 Chr 33:10; Ps 62:11; Job 33:29; Luke 24:25
v15 — Num 12:6; Job 4:13; Gen 31:24; Gen 20:3; Dan 4:5
v16 — Job 36:10; Job 36:15; Ps 40:6; Isa 50:5
v19 — Job 30:17
v23 — Mal 3:1; 2 Cor 5:20; Eccl 7:28
v25 — Ps 103:5; 2 Kgs 5:14; Josh 14:10-11; Deut 34:7; Job 42:16
v26 — Ps 50:15; Ps 30:5; Acts 9:11; Acts 2:28; Isa 30:19
v27 — Rom 6:21; 2 Sam 12:13; Ps 14:2
v30 — Ps 56:13; Isa 38:17

Chapter 34

Elihu defends God's justice, insisting that the Almighty cannot do wickedness and that He repays every man according to his work. He rebukes Job for adding rebellion to his sin and declares that God is no respecter of persons, striking down the mighty without investigation.

1	<i>Furthermore Elihu answered and said,</i>	Furthermore Elihu answered and said:
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| 2 <i>Hear my words, O ye wise men; and
give ear unto me, ye that have
knowledge.</i> | "Hear my words, O You wise men; and
give ear to me, You that have
knowledge. |
| 3 <i>For the ear trieth words, as the mouth
tasteth meat.</i> | For the ear tries words, as the mouth
tastes meat. |
| 4 <i>Let us choose to us judgment: let us
know among ourselves what is good.</i> | Let us choose to us judgment; let us
know among ourselves what is good. |
| 5 <i>For Job hath said, I am righteous:
and God hath taken away my
judgment.</i> | For Job has said, 'I am righteous; and
God has taken away my judgment. |
| 6 <i>Should I lie against my right? my
wound is incurable without
transgression.</i> | Should I lie against my right? My
wound is incurable without
transgression.' |
| 7 <i>What man is like Job, who drinketh up
scorning like water?</i> | What man is like Job, who drinks up
scorning like water? |
| 8 <i>Which goeth in company with the
workers of iniquity, and walketh with
wicked men.</i> | who goes in company with the workers
of iniquity, and walks with wicked
men. |
| 9 <i>For he hath said, It profiteth a man
nothing that he should delight himself
with God.</i> | For he has said, 'It profits a man
nothing that he should delight himself
with God.' |
| 10 <i>Therefore hearken unto me, ye men of
understanding: far be it from God,
that he should do wickedness; and
from the Almighty, that he should
commit iniquity.</i> | Therefore listen to me, You men of
understanding: far be it from God, that
He should do wickedness; and from
the Almighty, that He should commit
iniquity. |
| 11 <i>For the work of a man shall he render
unto him, and cause every man to find
according to his ways.</i> | For the work of a man shall he render
to him, and cause every man to find
according to his ways. |
| 12 <i>Yea, surely God will not do wickedly,
neither will the Almighty pervert
judgment.</i> | Yes, surely God will not do wickedly,
neither will the Almighty pervert
judgment. |

- 13 *Who hath given him a charge over the earth? or who hath disposed the whole world?* Who has given Him a charge over the earth? Or who has disposed the whole world?
- 14 *If he set his heart upon man, if he gather unto himself his spirit and his breath;* If He set His heart on man, if He gather to Himself His spirit and His breath,
- 15 *All flesh shall perish together, and man shall turn again unto dust.* all flesh shall perish together, and man shall turn again to dust.
- 16 *If now thou hast understanding, hear this: hearken to the voice of my words.* If now You have understanding, hear this; listen to the voice of my words.
- 17 *Shall even he that hateth right govern? and wilt thou condemn him that is most just?* Shall even He that hates right govern? And will you condemn him that is most just?
- 18 *Is it fit to say to a king, Thou art wicked? and to princes, Ye are ungodly?* Is it fit to say to a king, 'You are wicked'? And to princes, 'You are ungodly'?
- 19 *How much less to him that accepteth not the persons of princes, nor regardeth the rich more than the poor? for they all are the work of his hands.* How much less to Him that does not accept the persons of princes, nor regards the rich more than the poor? For they are all the work of His hands.
- 20 *In a moment shall they die, and the people shall be troubled at midnight, and pass away: and the mighty shall be taken away without hand.* In a moment shall they die, and the people shall be troubled at midnight, and pass away; and the mighty shall be taken away without hand.
- 21 *For his eyes are upon the ways of man, and he seeth all his goings.* For His eyes are on the ways of man, and He sees all His goings.
- 22 *There is no darkness, nor shadow of death, where the workers of iniquity may hide themselves.* There is no darkness, nor shadow of death, where the workers of iniquity may hide themselves.
- 23 *For he will not lay upon man more than right; that he should enter into judgment with God.* For He will not lay on man more than right, that He should enter into judgment with God.

- 24 *He shall break in pieces mighty men without number, and set others in their stead.* He shall break in pieces mighty men without number, and set others in their place.
- 25 *Therefore he knoweth their works, and he overturneth them in the night, so that they are destroyed.* Therefore He knows their works, and He overturns them in the night, so that they are destroyed.
- 26 *He striketh them as wicked men in the open sight of others;* He strikes them as wicked men in the open sight of others,
- 27 *Because they turned back from him, and would not consider any of his ways:* because they turned back from Him, and would not consider any of His ways,
- 28 *So that they cause the cry of the poor to come unto him, and he heareth the cry of the afflicted.* so that they cause the cry of the poor to come to Him, and He hears the cry of the afflicted.
- 29 *When he giveth quietness, who then can make trouble? and when he hideth his face, who then can behold him? whether it be done against a nation, or against a man only:* When He gives quietness, who then can make trouble? And when He hides His face, who then can see Him? Whether it be done against a nation, or against a man only —
- 30 *That the hypocrite reign not, lest the people be ensnared.* that the hypocrite reign not, lest the people be ensnared.
- 31 *Surely it is meet to be said unto God, I have borne chastisement, I will not offend any more:* Surely it is fit to be said to God, 'I have borne chastisement, I will not offend any more;
- 32 *That which I see not teach thou me: if I have done iniquity, I will do no more.* that which I do not see teach me; if I have done iniquity, I will do no more.'
- 33 *Should it be according to thy mind? he will recompense it, whether thou refuse, or whether thou choose; and not I: therefore speak what thou knowest.* Should it be according to Your mind? He will recompense it, whether You refuse, or whether You choose; and not I; therefore speak what You know.

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| <p>34 <i>Men of understanding will say unto me, yea, and the wise man who hearkeneth unto me:</i></p> <p>35 <i>Job hath spoken without knowledge, and his words were without wisdom.</i></p> <p>36 <i>My desire is that Job may be tried unto the end because of his answers for wicked men.</i></p> <p>37 <i>For he addeth rebellion unto his sin, he clappeth his hands among us, and multiplieth his words against God.</i></p> | <p>Men of understanding will say to me, yes, and the wise man who listens to me:</p> <p>'Job has spoken without knowledge, and his words were without wisdom.'</p> <p>My desire is that Job may be tried to the end because of his answers for wicked men.</p> <p>For he adds rebellion to his sin; he claps his hands among us, and multiplies his words against God."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v5 — Job 27:2; Job 33:9
- v8 — Ps 1:1; 1 Cor 15:33; Prov 13:20
- v9 — Job 35:3; Job 21:14-16
- v10 — Rom 9:14; Deut 32:4; 2 Chr 19:7; Job 8:3; Jas 1:13
- v11 — 2 Cor 5:10; Rom 2:6; Rev 22:12; Ps 62:12; Matt 16:27
- v17 — Rom 9:14; 2 Sam 23:3; Job 40:8; Gen 18:25
- v19 — Deut 10:17; Acts 10:34; Jas 2:5; Rom 2:11; Col 3:25
- v21 — Prov 15:3; Job 31:4; Jer 16:17; Prov 5:21; Jer 32:19
- v22 — Heb 4:13; Amos 9:2-3; Prov 10:29; Ps 139:11-12
- v27 — 1 Sam 15:11; Ps 28:5; Isa 5:12
- v28 — Jas 5:4; Ex 3:7; Job 35:9; Ps 12:5; Ex 3:9
- v32 — Ps 32:8; Ps 19:12; Ps 139:23-24; Ps 25:4-5

Chapter 35

Elihu argues that man's righteousness or wickedness does not affect God but only other men. He explains that the oppressed cry out but do not ask where God their maker is, and that God does not answer the empty cries of the proud.

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| <p>1 <i>Elihu spake moreover, and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Thinkest thou this to be right, that thou saidst, My righteousness is more than God's?</i></p> | <p>Elihu spoke moreover and said:</p> <p>"Do you think this to be right, that you said, 'My righteousness is more than God's'?</p> |
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| 3 <i>For thou saidst, What advantage will it be unto thee? and, What profit shall I have, if I be cleansed from my sin?</i> | For you said, 'What advantage will it be to you? And, what profit shall I have, if I be cleansed from my sin?' |
| 4 <i>I will answer thee, and thy companions with thee.</i> | I will answer you, and your companions with you. |
| 5 <i>Look unto the heavens, and see; and behold the clouds which are higher than thou.</i> | Look to the heavens, and see; and look at the clouds which are higher than you. |
| 6 <i>If thou sinnest, what doest thou against him? or if thy transgressions be multiplied, what doest thou unto him?</i> | If you sin, what do you against him? Or if your transgressions be multiplied, what do you to him? |
| 7 <i>If thou be righteous, what givest thou him? or what receiveth he of thine hand?</i> | If you be righteous, what give you him? Or what does he receive of your hand? |
| 8 <i>Thy wickedness may hurt a man as thou art; and thy righteousness may profit the son of man.</i> | Your wickedness may hurt a man as you are; and your righteousness may profit the son of man. |
| 9 <i>By reason of the multitude of oppressions they make the oppressed to cry: they cry out by reason of the arm of the mighty.</i> | By reason of the multitude of oppressions they make the oppressed to cry; they cry out by reason of the arm of the mighty. |
| 10 <i>But none saith, Where is God my maker, who giveth songs in the night;</i> | But none says, 'Where is God my maker, who gives songs in the night, |
| 11 <i>Who teacheth us more than the beasts of the earth, and maketh us wiser than the fowls of heaven?</i> | who teaches us more than the beasts of the earth, and makes us wiser than the fowls of heaven?' |
| 12 <i>There they cry, but none giveth answer, because of the pride of evil men.</i> | There they cry, but none gives answer, because of the pride of evil men. |
| 13 <i>Surely God will not hear vanity, neither will the Almighty regard it.</i> | Surely God will not hear vanity, neither will the Almighty regard it. |

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| <p>14 <i>Although thou sayest thou shalt not see him, yet judgment is before him; therefore trust thou in him.</i></p> <p>15 <i>But now, because it is not so, he hath visited in his anger; yet he knoweth it not in great extremity:</i></p> <p>16 <i>Therefore doth Job open his mouth in vain; he multiplieth words without knowledge.</i></p> | <p>Although You say You shall not see Him, yet judgment is before Him; therefore trust in Him.</p> <p>But now, because it is not so, He has visited in His anger; yet He does not know it in great extremity.</p> <p>Therefore does Job open his mouth in vain; he multiplies words without knowledge."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Job 34:9
- v5 — Job 22:12
- v6 — Jer 7:19; Prov 8:36
- v7 — Job 22:2-3; Ps 16:2; Rom 11:35; Luke 17:10; Prov 9:12
- v9 — Ex 2:23
- v10 — Ps 42:8; Ps 149:5; Acts 16:25; Ps 77:6
- v11 — Ps 94:12; Job 32:8; Job 36:22
- v12 — John 9:31; Prov 1:28
- v13 — Prov 15:29; Jas 4:3; Jer 11:11; Isa 1:15
- v14 — Job 9:11
- v16 — Job 38:2

Chapter 36

Elihu continues, declaring that God is mighty and does not despise any. He argues that God uses suffering to open the ears of the righteous and deliver them from affliction, and warns Job not to turn to iniquity. He then begins to exalt God's greatness in the storm.

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| <p>1 <i>Elihu also proceeded, and said,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Suffer me a little, and I will shew thee that I have yet to speak on God's behalf.</i></p> <p>3 <i>I will fetch my knowledge from afar, and will ascribe righteousness to my Maker.</i></p> | <p>Elihu also proceeded and said:</p> <p>"Allow me a little, and I will show you that I have yet to speak on God's behalf.</p> <p>I will fetch my knowledge from afar, and will ascribe righteousness to my Maker.</p> |
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| 4 | <i>For truly my words shall not be false: he that is perfect in knowledge is with thee.</i> | For truly my words shall not be false; he that is perfect in knowledge is with you. |
| 5 | <i>Behold, God is mighty, and despiseth not any: he is mighty in strength and wisdom.</i> | See, God is mighty, and does not despise any; He is mighty in strength and wisdom. |
| 6 | <i>He preserveth not the life of the wicked: but giveth right to the poor.</i> | He does not preserve the life of the wicked, but gives right to the poor. |
| 7 | <i>He withdraweth not his eyes from the righteous: but with kings are they on the throne; yea, he doth establish them for ever, and they are exalted.</i> | He does not withdraw his eyes from the righteous; but with kings are they on the throne; yes, he does establish them for ever, and they are exalted. |
| 8 | <i>And if they be bound in fetters, and be holden in cords of affliction;</i> | And if they be bound in fetters, and be held in cords of affliction, |
| 9 | <i>Then he sheweth them their work, and their transgressions that they have exceeded.</i> | then he shows them their work, and their transgressions that they have exceeded. |
| 10 | <i>He openeth also their ear to discipline, and commandeth that they return from iniquity.</i> | He opens also their ear to discipline, and commands that they return from iniquity. |
| 11 | <i>If they obey and serve him, they shall spend their days in prosperity, and their years in pleasures.</i> | If they obey and serve him, they shall spend their days in prosperity, and their years in pleasures. |
| 12 | <i>But if they obey not, they shall perish by the sword, and they shall die without knowledge.</i> | But if they do not obey, they shall perish by the sword, and they shall die without knowledge. |
| 13 | <i>But the hypocrites in heart heap up wrath: they cry not when he bindeth them.</i> | But the hypocrites in heart heap up wrath; they do not cry when he binds them. |
| 14 | <i>They die in youth, and their life is among the unclean.</i> | They die in youth, and their life is among the unclean. |
| 15 | <i>He delivereth the poor in his affliction, and openeth their ears in oppression.</i> | He delivers the poor in his affliction, and opens their ears in oppression. |

- 16 *Even so would he have removed thee out of the strait into a broad place, where there is no straitness; and that which should be set on thy table should be full of fatness.* Even so would he have removed you out of the strait into a broad place, where there is no straitness; and that which should be set on your table should be full of fatness.
- 17 *But thou hast fulfilled the judgment of the wicked: judgment and justice take hold on thee.* But you have fulfilled the judgment of the wicked; judgment and justice take hold on you.
- 18 *Because there is wrath, beware lest he take thee away with his stroke: then a great ransom cannot deliver thee.* Because there is wrath, beware lest he take you away with his stroke; then a great ransom cannot deliver you.
- 19 *Will he esteem thy riches? no, not gold, nor all the forces of strength.* Will he esteem your riches? No, not gold, nor all the forces of strength.
- 20 *Desire not the night, when people are cut off in their place.* Do not desire the night, when people are cut off in their place.
- 21 *Take heed, regard not iniquity: for this hast thou chosen rather than affliction.* Take heed, regard not iniquity; for this you have chosen rather than affliction.
- 22 *Behold, God exalteth by his power: who teacheth like him?* See, God exalts by His power; who teaches like Him?
- 23 *Who hath enjoined him his way? or who can say, Thou hast wrought iniquity?* Who has enjoined him his way? Or who can say, 'You have wrought iniquity'?
- 24 *Remember that thou magnify his work, which men behold.* Remember that you magnify his work, which men see.
- 25 *Every man may see it; man may behold it afar off.* Every man may see it; man may see it from afar.
- 26 *Behold, God is great, and we know him not, neither can the number of his years be searched out.* See, God is great, and we do not know Him, neither can the number of His years be searched out.
- 27 *For he maketh small the drops of water: they pour down rain according to the vapour thereof:* For he makes small the drops of water; they pour down rain according to the vapour of it,

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| 28 | <i>Which the clouds do drop and distil upon man abundantly.</i> | which the clouds drop and distil on man abundantly. |
| 29 | <i>Also can any understand the spreadings of the clouds, or the noise of his tabernacle?</i> | Also can any understand the spreadings of the clouds, or the noise of his tabernacle? |
| 30 | <i>Behold, he spreadeth his light upon it, and covereth the bottom of the sea.</i> | See, he spreads his light on it, and covers the bottom of the sea. |
| 31 | <i>For by them judgeth he the people; he giveth meat in abundance.</i> | For by them he judges the people; he gives meat in abundance. |
| 32 | <i>With clouds he covereth the light; and commandeth it not to shine by the cloud that cometh betwixt.</i> | With clouds he covers the light; and commands it not to shine by the cloud that comes between. |
| 33 | <i>The noise thereof sheweth concerning it, the cattle also concerning the vapour.</i> | The noise of it shows concerning it, the cattle also concerning the vapour. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v5 — Ps 22:24; Ps 138:6; Jer 10:12; Ps 147:5; Job 37:23
v6 — Ps 140:12; Ps 72:12-14; Ex 22:22-24; Job 5:15; Ps 72:4
v7 — Ps 34:15; Ps 33:18; 1 Sam 2:8; Ps 113:7-8; 2 Thess 3:3
v11 — Jer 7:23; Isa 1:19; Jer 26:13; Heb 11:8; Deut 4:30
v13 — Rom 2:5; Job 27:8-10; Job 36:8
v15 — Job 36:10
v16 — Ps 23:5; Ps 118:5; Ps 63:5; Ps 18:19; Ps 31:8
v18 — Job 33:24; Eph 5:6; Rom 1:18
v21 — Ps 66:18; Heb 11:25; 1 Pet 3:17
v22 — 1 Sam 2:7-8; Luke 1:52; Rom 13:1; Isa 48:17; Jer 27:5-8
v26 — Ps 90:2; Ps 145:3; Job 11:7-9; Job 37:23; 1 Kgs 8:27
v31 — Ps 136:25; Acts 14:17; Job 37:13

Chapter 37

Elihu marvels at the thunder, lightning, snow, and storm by which God displays His power. He declares that God directs the weather for correction, mercy, or judgment, and challenges Job to consider the wondrous works of the Almighty whom no man can find out.

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| 1 | <i>At this also my heart trembleth, and is moved out of his place.</i> | At this also my heart trembles, and is moved out of His place. |
| 2 | <i>Hear attentively the noise of his voice, and the sound that goeth out of his mouth.</i> | Hear attentively the noise of His voice, and the sound that goes out of His mouth. |
| 3 | <i>He directeth it under the whole heaven, and his lightning unto the ends of the earth.</i> | He directs it under the whole heaven, and His lightning to the ends of the earth. |
| 4 | <i>After it a voice roareth: he thundereth with the voice of his excellency; and he will not stay them when his voice is heard.</i> | After it a voice roars; He thunders with the voice of His excellency; and He will not stay them when His voice is heard. |
| 5 | <i>God thundereth marvellously with his voice; great things doeth he, which we cannot comprehend.</i> | God thunders marvellously with His voice; great things does He, which we cannot comprehend. |
| 6 | <i>For he saith to the snow, Be thou on the earth; likewise to the small rain, and to the great rain of his strength.</i> | For He says to the snow, 'Be on the earth'; likewise to the small rain, and to the great rain of His strength. |
| 7 | <i>He sealeth up the hand of every man; that all men may know his work.</i> | He seals up the hand of every man, that all men may know his work. |
| 8 | <i>Then the beasts go into dens, and remain in their places.</i> | Then the beasts go into dens, and remain in their places. |
| 9 | <i>Out of the south cometh the whirlwind: and cold out of the north.</i> | Out of the south comes the whirlwind, and cold out of the north. |
| 10 | <i>By the breath of God frost is given: and the breadth of the waters is straitened.</i> | By the breath of God frost is given; and the breadth of the waters is straitened. |
| 11 | <i>Also by watering he wearieth the thick cloud: he scattereth his bright cloud:</i> | Also by watering He wearies the thick cloud; He scatters His bright cloud. |
| 12 | <i>And it is turned round about by his counsels: that they may do whatsoever he commandeth them upon the face of the world in the earth.</i> | And it is turned round about by His counsels, that they may do whatever He commands them on the face of the world in the earth. |

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| 13 <i>He causeth it to come, whether for correction, or for his land, or for mercy.</i> | He causes it to come, whether for correction, or for His land, or for mercy. |
| 14 <i>Hearken unto this, O Job: stand still, and consider the wondrous works of God.</i> | Listen to this, O Job; stand still, and consider the wondrous works of God. |
| 15 <i>Dost thou know when God disposed them, and caused the light of his cloud to shine?</i> | Do you know when God disposed them, and caused the light of His cloud to shine? |
| 16 <i>Dost thou know the balancings of the clouds, the wondrous works of him which is perfect in knowledge?</i> | Do you know the balancings of the clouds, the wondrous works of him which is perfect in knowledge? |
| 17 <i>How thy garments are warm, when he quieteth the earth by the south wind?</i> | How your garments are warm, when he quiets the earth by the south wind? |
| 18 <i>Hast thou with him spread out the sky, which is strong, and as a molten looking glass?</i> | Have you with him spread out the sky, which is strong, and as a molten looking glass? |
| 19 <i>Teach us what we shall say unto him; for we cannot order our speech by reason of darkness.</i> | Teach us what we shall say to him; for we cannot order our speech by reason of darkness. |
| 20 <i>Shall it be told him that I speak? if a man speak, surely he shall be swallowed up.</i> | Shall it be told him that I speak? If a man speak, surely he shall be swallowed up. |
| 21 <i>And now men see not the bright light which is in the clouds: but the wind passeth, and cleanseth them.</i> | And now men do not see the bright light which is in the clouds; but the wind passes, and cleanses them. |
| 22 <i>Fair weather cometh out of the north: with God is terrible majesty.</i> | Fair weather comes out of the north; with God is terrible majesty. |
| 23 <i>Touching the Almighty, we cannot find him out: he is excellent in power, and in judgment, and in plenty of justice: he will not afflict.</i> | Touching the Almighty, we cannot find Him out; He is excellent in power, and in judgment, and in plenty of justice; He will not afflict. |

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| <p>24 <i>Men do therefore fear him: he respecteth not any that are wise of heart.</i></p> | <p>Men therefore fear Him; He respects not any that are wise of heart."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Job 37:5; Job 36:33
- v3 — Job 38:13; Matt 24:27
- v5 — Job 5:9; Rom 11:33; Job 9:10; Eccl 3:11; Isa 40:28
- v7 — Ps 111:2
- v10 — Job 38:29-30; Ps 147:16-18
- v12 — Ps 148:8
- v13 — 1 Kgs 18:45; Job 38:26-27; 1 Sam 12:18-19
- v14 — Ps 145:10-12; Ps 111:2; Ex 14:13; Hab 2:20; Ps 145:5-6
- v16 — Job 36:4
- v18 — Isa 44:24
- v23 — 1 Tim 6:16; Rom 11:33; Job 36:5; Ps 99:4; Lam 3:32-33
- v24 — Matt 10:28

Chapter 38

The LORD answers Job out of the whirlwind, demanding to know where Job was when He laid the foundations of the earth. God interrogates Job with unanswerable questions about the sea, the dawn, the storehouses of snow, the constellations, and the rain -- revealing that Job cannot comprehend even the natural order, let alone the moral one.

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| <p>1 <i>Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind, and said,</i></p> | <p>Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind and said:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Who is this that darkeneth counsel by words without knowledge?</i></p> | <p>"Who is this that darkens counsel by words without knowledge?</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Gird up now thy loins like a man; for I will demand of thee, and answer thou me.</i></p> | <p>Gird up now Your loins like a man; for I will demand of you, and answer me.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Where wast thou when I laid the foundations of the earth? declare, if thou hast understanding.</i></p> | <p>Where were You when I laid the foundations of the earth? Declare, if You have understanding.</p> |

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| <p>5 <i>Who hath laid the measures thereof, if thou knowest? or who hath stretched the line upon it?</i></p> <p>6 <i>Whereupon are the foundations thereof fastened? or who laid the corner stone thereof;</i></p> <p>7 <i>When the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy?</i></p> <p>8 <i>Or who shut up the sea with doors, when it brake forth, as if it had issued out of the womb?</i></p> <p>9 <i>When I made the cloud the garment thereof, and thick darkness a swaddlingband for it,</i></p> <p>10 <i>And brake up for it my decreed place, and set bars and doors,</i></p> <p>11 <i>And said, Hitherto shalt thou come, but no further: and here shall thy proud waves be stayed?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Hast thou commanded the morning since thy days; and caused the dayspring to know his place;</i></p> <p>13 <i>That it might take hold of the ends of the earth, that the wicked might be shaken out of it?</i></p> <p>14 <i>It is turned as clay to the seal; and they stand as a garment.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And from the wicked their light is withholden, and the high arm shall be broken.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Hast thou entered into the springs of the sea? or hast thou walked in the search of the depth?</i></p> | <p>Who has laid the measures of it, if You know? Or who has stretched the line on it?</p> <p>On what are the foundations of it fastened? Or who laid the corner stone of it,</p> <p>when the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy?</p> <p>Or who shut up the sea with doors, when it broke forth, as if it had issued out of the womb?</p> <p>When I made the cloud the garment of it, and thick darkness a swaddling-band for it,</p> <p>and broke up for it my decreed place, and set bars and doors,</p> <p>and said, 'Up to here shall You come, but no further; and here shall Your proud waves be stayed'?</p> <p>Have You commanded the morning since Your days, and caused the dayspring to know His place,</p> <p>that it might take hold of the ends of the earth, that the wicked might be shaken out of it?</p> <p>It is turned as clay to the seal; and they stand as a garment.</p> <p>And from the wicked their light is withheld, and the high arm shall be broken.</p> <p>Have you entered into the springs of the sea? Or have you walked in the search of the depth?</p> |
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- 17 *Have the gates of death been opened unto thee? or hast thou seen the doors of the shadow of death?* Have the gates of death been opened to you? Or have you seen the doors of the shadow of death?
- 18 *Hast thou perceived the breadth of the earth? declare if thou knowest it all.* Have you perceived the breadth of the earth? Declare if you know it all.
- 19 *Where is the way where light dwelleth? and as for darkness, where is the place thereof,* Where is the way where light dwells? And as for darkness, where is the place of it,
- 20 *That thou shouldest take it to the bound thereof, and that thou shouldest know the paths to the house thereof?* that you should take it to the bound of it, and that you should know the paths to the house of it?
- 21 *Knowest thou it, because thou wast then born? or because the number of thy days is great?* Do you know it, because you were then born? Or because the number of your days is great?
- 22 *Hast thou entered into the treasures of the snow? or hast thou seen the treasures of the hail,* Have you entered into the treasures of the snow? Or have you seen the treasures of the hail,
- 23 *Which I have reserved against the time of trouble, against the day of battle and war?* which I have reserved against the time of trouble, against the day of battle and war?
- 24 *By what way is the light parted, which scattereth the east wind upon the earth?* By what way is the light parted, which scatters the east wind on the earth?
- 25 *Who hath divided a watercourse for the overflowing of waters, or a way for the lightning of thunder;* Who has divided a watercourse for the overflowing of waters, or a way for the lightning of thunder,
- 26 *To cause it to rain on the earth, where no man is; on the wilderness, wherein there is no man;* to cause it to rain on the earth, where no man is; on the wilderness, in which there is no man;
- 27 *To satisfy the desolate and waste ground; and to cause the bud of the tender herb to spring forth?* to satisfy the desolate and waste ground; and to cause the bud of the tender herb to spring forth?
- 28 *Hath the rain a father? or who hath begotten the drops of dew?* Has the rain a father? Or who has begotten the drops of dew?

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| <p>29 <i>Out of whose womb came the ice? and the hoary frost of heaven, who hath gendered it?</i></p> <p>30 <i>The waters are hid as with a stone, and the face of the deep is frozen.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Canst thou bind the sweet influences of Pleiades, or loose the bands of Orion?</i></p> <p>32 <i>Canst thou bring forth Mazzaroth in his season? or canst thou guide Arcturus with his sons?</i></p> <p>33 <i>Knowest thou the ordinances of heaven? canst thou set the dominion thereof in the earth?</i></p> <p>34 <i>Canst thou lift up thy voice to the clouds, that abundance of waters may cover thee?</i></p> <p>35 <i>Canst thou send lightnings, that they may go, and say unto thee, Here we are?</i></p> <p>36 <i>Who hath put wisdom in the inward parts? or who hath given understanding to the heart?</i></p> <p>37 <i>Who can number the clouds in wisdom? or who can stay the bottles of heaven,</i></p> <p>38 <i>When the dust groweth into hardness, and the clods cleave fast together?</i></p> <p>39 <i>Wilt thou hunt the prey for the lion? or fill the appetite of the young lions,</i></p> <p>40 <i>When they couch in their dens, and abide in the covert to lie in wait?</i></p> | <p>Out of whose womb came the ice? And the hoary frost of heaven, who has gendered it?</p> <p>The waters are hidden as with a stone, and the face of the deep is frozen.</p> <p>Can you bind the sweet influences of Pleiades, or loose the bands of Orion?</p> <p>Can you bring forth Mazzaroth in his season? Or can you guide Arcturus with his sons?</p> <p>Do you know the ordinances of heaven? Can you set the dominion thereof in the earth?</p> <p>Can you lift up your voice to the clouds, that abundance of waters may cover you?</p> <p>Can you send lightnings, that they may go, and say to you, 'Here we are'?</p> <p>Who has put wisdom in the inward parts? Or who has given understanding to the heart?</p> <p>Who can number the clouds in wisdom? Or who can stay the bottles of heaven,</p> <p>when the dust grows into hardness, and the clods cleave fast together?</p> <p>Will you hunt the prey for the lion? Or fill the appetite of the young lions,</p> <p>when they couch in their dens, and abide in the covert to lie in wait?</p> |
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- 41 *Who provideth for the raven his food? Who provides for the raven his food?
when his young ones cry unto God, When his young ones cry to God, they
they wander for lack of meat. wander for lack of meat."*

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 40:6; Job 37:1-2; 2 Kgs 2:11; Ex 19:16-19; 1 Kgs 19:11
v4 — Ps 104:5; Heb 1:10; Prov 30:4; Heb 1:2
v5 — Isa 40:12; Job 11:9; Zech 2:1-2; Prov 8:27; Ps 78:55
v6 — Job 26:7; Ps 104:5; Ps 93:1; 2 Pet 3:5; Ps 118:22
v7 — Rev 5:11; Job 1:6; Ezra 3:11-12; Rev 22:16
v8 — Gen 1:9; Jer 5:22; Prov 8:29; Ps 104:8-9; Ps 33:7
v12 — Ps 74:16; Ps 148:3-5; Gen 1:5; Job 8:9
v15 — Ps 10:15; Ps 37:17; Job 18:5; Prov 4:19
v23 — Josh 10:11; Isa 30:30; Ex 9:18; Job 36:13; Ezek 13:11-13
v33 — Jer 31:35-36; Gen 8:22; Ps 148:6; Job 38:12-13; Gen 1:16
v36 — Job 32:8; Ps 51:6; Eccl 2:26; Prov 2:6; Jas 1:5
v41 — Luke 12:24; Matt 6:26; Ps 147:9

Chapter 39

God continues His speech, asking Job whether he can govern the wild goats, the unicorn, the ostrich, the horse, or the hawk. Each creature displays God's sovereign design beyond human control, and God challenges Job's right to question the One who orders all living things.

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| 1 | <i>Knowest thou the time when the wild goats of the rock bring forth? or canst thou mark when the hinds do calve?</i> | <i>"Do you know the time when the wild goats of the rock bring forth? Or can you mark when the hinds do calve?</i> |
| 2 | <i>Canst thou number the months that they fulfil? or knowest thou the time when they bring forth?</i> | <i>Can you number the months that they fulfil? Or do you know the time when they bring forth?</i> |
| 3 | <i>They bow themselves, they bring forth their young ones, they cast out their sorrows.</i> | <i>They bow themselves, they bring forth their young ones, they cast out their sorrows.</i> |
| 4 | <i>Their young ones are in good liking, they grow up with corn; they go forth, and return not unto them.</i> | <i>Their young ones are in good liking; they grow up with corn; they go forth, and return not to them.</i> |

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| 5 <i>Who hath sent out the wild ass free?
or who hath loosed the bands of the
wild ass?</i> | Who has sent out the wild ass free? Or
who has loosed the bands of the wild
ass? |
| 6 <i>Whose house I have made the
wilderness, and the barren land his
dwellings.</i> | Whose house I have made the
wilderness, and the barren land his
dwellings. |
| 7 <i>He scorneth the multitude of the city,
neither regardeth he the crying of the
driver.</i> | He scorns the multitude of the city,
neither does he regard the crying of the
driver. |
| 8 <i>The range of the mountains is his
pasture, and he searcheth after every
green thing.</i> | The range of the mountains is his
pasture, and he searches after every
green thing. |
| 9 <i>Will the unicorn be willing to serve
thee, or abide by thy crib?</i> | Will the unicorn be willing to serve
you, or abide by your crib? |
| 10 <i>Canst thou bind the unicorn with his
band in the furrow? or will he harrow
the valleys after thee?</i> | Can you bind the unicorn with his band
in the furrow? Or will he harrow the
valleys after you? |
| 11 <i>Wilt thou trust him, because his
strength is great? or wilt thou leave
thy labour to him?</i> | Will you trust him, because his
strength is great? Or will you leave
your labour to him? |
| 12 <i>Wilt thou believe him, that he will
bring home thy seed, and gather it
into thy barn?</i> | Will you believe him, that he will
bring home your seed, and gather it
into your barn? |
| 13 <i>Gavest thou the goodly wings unto the
peacocks? or wings and feathers unto
the ostrich?</i> | Did you give the goodly wings to the
peacocks? Or wings and feathers to the
ostrich? |
| 14 <i>Which leaveth her eggs in the earth,
and warmeth them in dust,</i> | Who leaves her eggs in the earth, and
warms them in dust, |
| 15 <i>And forgetteth that the foot may crush
them, or that the wild beast may break
them.</i> | and forgets that the foot may crush
them, or that the wild beast may break
them. |
| 16 <i>She is hardened against her young
ones, as though they were not hers:
her labour is in vain without fear;</i> | She is hardened against her young
ones, as though they were not hers; her
labour is in vain without fear; |

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| 17 <i>Because God hath deprived her of wisdom, neither hath he imparted to her understanding.</i> | because God has deprived her of wisdom, neither has He imparted to her understanding. |
| 18 <i>What time she lifteth up herself on high, she scorneth the horse and his rider.</i> | What time she lifts up herself on high, she scorns the horse and his rider. |
| 19 <i>Hast thou given the horse strength? hast thou clothed his neck with thunder?</i> | Have you given the horse strength? Have you clothed his neck with thunder? |
| 20 <i>Canst thou make him afraid as a grasshopper? the glory of his nostrils is terrible.</i> | Can you make him afraid as a grasshopper? The glory of his nostrils is terrible. |
| 21 <i>He paweth in the valley, and rejoiceth in his strength: he goeth on to meet the armed men.</i> | He paws in the valley, and rejoices in his strength; he goes on to meet the armed men. |
| 22 <i>He mocketh at fear, and is not affrighted; neither turneth he back from the sword.</i> | He mocks at fear, and is not frightened; neither does he turn back from the sword. |
| 23 <i>The quiver rattleth against him, the glittering spear and the shield.</i> | The quiver rattles against him, the glittering spear and the shield. |
| 24 <i>He swalloweth the ground with fierceness and rage: neither believeth he that it is the sound of the trumpet.</i> | He swallows the ground with fierceness and rage; neither does he believe that it is the sound of the trumpet. |
| 25 <i>He saith among the trumpets, Ha, ha; and he smelleth the battle afar off, the thunder of the captains, and the shouting.</i> | He says among the trumpets, 'Ha, ha!' And he smells the battle from afar, the thunder of the captains, and the shouting. |
| 26 <i>Doth the hawk fly by thy wisdom, and stretch her wings toward the south?</i> | Does the hawk fly by your wisdom, and stretch her wings toward the south? |
| 27 <i>Doth the eagle mount up at thy command, and make her nest on high?</i> | Does the eagle mount up at your command, and make her nest on high? |

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| 28 | <i>She dwelleth and abideth on the rock, upon the crag of the rock, and the strong place.</i> | She dwells and abides on the rock, on the crag of the rock, and the strong place. |
| 29 | <i>From thence she seeketh the prey, and her eyes behold afar off.</i> | From there she seeks the prey, and her eyes see from afar. |
| 30 | <i>Her young ones also suck up blood: and where the slain are, there is she.</i> | Her young ones also suck up blood; and where the slain are, there is she." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 29:9
v9 — Num 23:22; Ps 92:10; Deut 33:17
v16 — Lam 4:3
v17 — Job 35:11
v20 — Jer 8:16
v21 — Jer 8:6
v27 — Obad 1:4; Jer 49:16
v30 — Matt 24:28; Luke 17:37

Chapter 40

The LORD challenges Job: shall he that contends with the Almighty instruct Him? Job confesses he is vile and lays his hand on his mouth. God speaks again, asking if Job has an arm like God, and describes the behemoth -- a mighty creature that only its Maker can approach.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover the LORD answered Job, and said,</i> | Moreover the LORD answered Job and said: |
| 2 | <i>Shall he that contendeth with the Almighty instruct him? he that reproveth God, let him answer it.</i> | "Shall He that contends with the Almighty instruct Him? He that reproves God, let Him answer it." |
| 3 | <i>Then Job answered the LORD, and said,</i> | Then Job answered the LORD and said: |
| 4 | <i>Behold, I am vile; what shall I answer thee? I will lay mine hand upon my mouth.</i> | "See, I am vile; what shall I answer You? I will lay my hand on my mouth. |

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| <p>5 <i>Once have I spoken; but I will not answer: yea, twice; but I will proceed no further.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Then answered the LORD unto Job out of the whirlwind, and said,</i></p> <p>7 <i>Gird up thy loins now like a man: I will demand of thee, and declare thou unto me.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Wilt thou also disannul my judgment? wilt thou condemn me, that thou mayest be righteous?</i></p> <p>9 <i>Hast thou an arm like God? or canst thou thunder with a voice like him?</i></p> <p>10 <i>Deck thyself now with majesty and excellency; and array thyself with glory and beauty.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Cast abroad the rage of thy wrath: and behold every one that is proud, and abase him.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Look on every one that is proud, and bring him low; and tread down the wicked in their place.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Hide them in the dust together; and bind their faces in secret.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then will I also confess unto thee that thine own right hand can save thee.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Behold now behemoth, which I made with thee; he eateth grass as an ox.</i></p> | <p>Once I have spoken; but I will not answer; yes, twice; but I will proceed no further."</p> <p>Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind and said:</p> <p>"Gird up Your loins now like a man; I will demand of you, and declare to me.</p> <p>Will You also disannul my judgment? Will You condemn me, that You may be righteous?</p> <p>Have You an arm like God? Or can You thunder with a voice like Him?</p> <p>Deck Yourself now with majesty and excellency; and array Yourself with glory and beauty.</p> <p>Cast abroad the rage of Your wrath; and look at every one who is proud, and abase him.</p> <p>Look on every one that is proud, and bring him low; and tread down the wicked in their place.</p> <p>Hide them in the dust together; and bind their faces in secret.</p> <p>Then will I also confess to you that your own right hand can save you.</p> <p>See now Behemoth, which I made with you; he eats grass as an ox.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Behemoth** (beh-HEE-moth) — A mighty beast described by God; traditionally understood as a land creature of enormous power.

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| <p>16 <i>Lo now, his strength is in his loins, and his force is in the navel of his belly.</i></p> | <p>His strength is in his loins, and his force is in the navel of his belly.</p> |
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| <p>17 <i>He moveth his tail like a cedar: the sinews of his stones are wrapped together.</i></p> <p>18 <i>His bones are as strong pieces of brass; his bones are like bars of iron.</i></p> <p>19 <i>He is the chief of the ways of God: he that made him can make his sword to approach unto him.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Surely the mountains bring him forth food, where all the beasts of the field play.</i></p> <p>21 <i>He lieth under the shady trees, in the covert of the reed, and fens.</i></p> <p>22 <i>The shady trees cover him with their shadow; the willows of the brook compass him about.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Behold, he drinketh up a river, and hasteth not: he trusteth that he can draw up Jordan into his mouth.</i></p> <p>24 <i>He taketh it with his eyes: his nose pierceth through snares.</i></p> | <p>He moves his tail like a cedar; the sinews of his stones are wrapped together.</p> <p>His bones are as strong pieces of brass; his bones are like bars of iron.</p> <p>He is the chief of the ways of God; He that made him can make his sword to approach to Him.</p> <p>Surely the mountains bring him forth food, where all the beasts of the field play.</p> <p>He lies under the shady trees, in the covert of the reed, and fens.</p> <p>The shady trees cover him with their shadow; the willows of the brook compass him about.</p> <p>See, he drinks up a river, and does not hasten; he trusts that he can draw up Jordan into his mouth.</p> <p>He takes it with his eyes; his nose pierces through snares."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 Cor 2:16; Isa 40:14; Rom 11:34-36; Job 33:13; Isa 50:8
- v4** — Prov 30:32; Job 29:9; Job 21:5; Job 42:6; Judg 18:19
- v5** — Ps 62:11; Job 33:14
- v6** — Job 38:1
- v7** — Job 38:3; Job 42:4
- v8** — Rom 3:4
- v10** — Ps 93:1
- v11** — Dan 4:37
- v13** — Isa 2:10

Chapter 41

God describes Leviathan, a terrifying creature that no man can tame, hook, or subdue. Fire and smoke pour from its mouth, its scales are its pride, and no weapon can pierce it. God declares that everything under heaven is His -- if no one can stand before Leviathan, who can stand before its Maker?

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| 1 | <i>Canst thou draw out leviathan with an hook? or his tongue with a cord which thou lettest down?</i> | <i>"Can you draw out Leviathan with a hook? Or his tongue with a cord which you let down?</i> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Leviathan** (leh-VY-ah-than) — A fearsome sea creature described by God; used throughout Scripture as a symbol of untamable power that only God can master.

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| 2 | <i>Canst thou put an hook into his nose? or bore his jaw through with a thorn?</i> | <i>Can you put a hook into his nose? Or bore his jaw through with a thorn?</i> |
| 3 | <i>Will he make many supplications unto thee? will he speak soft words unto thee?</i> | <i>Will he make many supplications to you? Will he speak soft words to you?</i> |
| 4 | <i>Will he make a covenant with thee? wilt thou take him for a servant for ever?</i> | <i>Will he make a covenant with you? Will you take him for a servant for ever?</i> |
| 5 | <i>Wilt thou play with him as with a bird? or wilt thou bind him for thy maidens?</i> | <i>Will you play with him as with a bird? Or will you bind him for your maidens?</i> |
| 6 | <i>Shall the companions make a banquet of him? shall they part him among the merchants?</i> | <i>Shall the companions make a banquet of him? Shall they part him among the merchants?</i> |
| 7 | <i>Canst thou fill his skin with barbed irons? or his head with fish spears?</i> | <i>Can you fill his skin with barbed irons? Or his head with fish spears?</i> |
| 8 | <i>Lay thine hand upon him, remember the battle, do no more.</i> | <i>Lay your hand on him; remember the battle; do no more.</i> |
| 9 | <i>Behold, the hope of him is in vain: shall not one be cast down even at the sight of him?</i> | <i>See, the hope of him is in vain; shall not one be cast down even at the sight of him?</i> |
| 10 | <i>None is so fierce that dare stir him up: who then is able to stand before me?</i> | <i>None is so fierce that dare stir him up; who then is able to stand before me?</i> |

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| 11 <i>Who hath prevented me, that I should repay him? whatsoever is under the whole heaven is mine.</i> | Who has prevented me, that I should repay him? Whatever is under the whole heaven is mine. |
| 12 <i>I will not conceal his parts, nor his power, nor his comely proportion.</i> | I will not conceal his parts, nor his power, nor his comely proportion. |
| 13 <i>Who can discover the face of his garment? or who can come to him with his double bridle?</i> | Who can discover the face of his garment? Or who can come to him with his double bridle? |
| 14 <i>Who can open the doors of his face? his teeth are terrible round about.</i> | Who can open the doors of his face? His teeth are terrible round about. |
| 15 <i>His scales are his pride, shut up together as with a close seal.</i> | His scales are his pride, shut up together as with a close seal. |
| 16 <i>One is so near to another, that no air can come between them.</i> | One is so near to another, that no air can come between them. |
| 17 <i>They are joined one to another, they stick together, that they cannot be sundered.</i> | They are joined one to another; they stick together, that they cannot be sundered. |
| 18 <i>By his neesings a light doth shine, and his eyes are like the eyelids of the morning.</i> | By his sneezings a light shines, and his eyes are like the eyelids of the morning. |
| 19 <i>Out of his mouth go burning lamps, and sparks of fire leap out.</i> | Out of his mouth go burning lamps, and sparks of fire leap out. |
| 20 <i>Out of his nostrils goeth smoke, as out of a seething pot or caldron.</i> | Out of his nostrils goes smoke, as out of a seething pot or caldron. |
| 21 <i>His breath kindleth coals, and a flame goeth out of his mouth.</i> | His breath kindles coals, and a flame goes out of his mouth. |
| 22 <i>In his neck remaineth strength, and sorrow is turned into joy before him.</i> | In his neck remains strength, and sorrow is turned into joy before him. |
| 23 <i>The flakes of his flesh are joined together: they are firm in themselves; they cannot be moved.</i> | The flakes of his flesh are joined together; they are firm in themselves; they cannot be moved. |

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| <p>24 <i>His heart is as firm as a stone; yea, as hard as a piece of the nether millstone.</i></p> <p>25 <i>When he raiseth up himself, the mighty are afraid: by reason of breakings they purify themselves.</i></p> <p>26 <i>The sword of him that layeth at him cannot hold: the spear, the dart, nor the habergeon.</i></p> <p>27 <i>He esteemeth iron as straw, and brass as rotten wood.</i></p> <p>28 <i>The arrow cannot make him flee: slingstones are turned with him into stubble.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Darts are counted as stubble: he laugheth at the shaking of a spear.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Sharp stones are under him; he spreadeth sharp pointed things upon the mire.</i></p> <p>31 <i>He maketh the deep to boil like a pot: he maketh the sea like a pot of ointment.</i></p> <p>32 <i>He maketh a path to shine after him; one would think the deep to be hoary.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Upon earth there is not his like, who is made without fear.</i></p> <p>34 <i>He beholdeth all high things: he is a king over all the children of pride.</i></p> | <p>His heart is as firm as a stone; yes, as hard as a piece of the nether millstone.</p> <p>When he raises up himself, the mighty are afraid; by reason of breakings they purify themselves.</p> <p>The sword of him that lays at him cannot hold — the spear, the dart, nor the habergeon.</p> <p>He esteems iron as straw, and brass as rotten wood.</p> <p>The arrow cannot make him flee; slingstones are turned with him into stubble.</p> <p>Darts are counted as stubble; he laughs at the shaking of a spear.</p> <p>Sharp stones are under him; he spreads sharp pointed things on the mire.</p> <p>He makes the deep to boil like a pot; he makes the sea like a pot of ointment.</p> <p>He makes a path to shine after him; one would think the deep to be hoary.</p> <p>On earth there is not his like, who is made without fear.</p> <p>He beholds all high things; he is a king over all the children of pride."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 104:26; Ps 74:14; Isa 27:1; Job 3:8

v2 — Isa 37:29

v11 — Rom 11:35; Ps 24:1; Job 35:7; 1 Chr 29:11-14; Ps 50:12

v18 — Job 3:9

v34 — Ezek 29:3

Chapter 42

Job repented in dust and ashes, confessing that he had spoken of things too wonderful for him. The LORD rebuked the three friends for not speaking rightly and commanded them to offer sacrifices while Job prayed for them. God restored Job's fortunes double and blessed his latter end more than his beginning.

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| 1 | <i>Then Job answered the LORD, and said,</i> | Then Job answered the LORD and said: |
| 2 | <i>I know that thou canst do every thing, and that no thought can be withholden from thee.</i> | "I know that You can do every thing, and that no thought can be withheld from You. |
| 3 | <i>Who is he that hideth counsel without knowledge? therefore have I uttered that I understood not; things too wonderful for me, which I knew not.</i> | 'Who is He that hides counsel without knowledge?' Therefore have I uttered that I did not understand, things too wonderful for me, which I did not know. |
| 4 | <i>Hear, I beseech thee, and I will speak: I will demand of thee, and declare thou unto me.</i> | 'Hear, I beseech You, and I will speak; I will demand of You, and declare to me.' |
| 5 | <i>I have heard of thee by the hearing of the ear: but now mine eye seeth thee.</i> | I have heard of You by the hearing of the ear; but now my eye sees You. |
| 6 | <i>Wherefore I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes.</i> | Therefore I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes." |
| 7 | <i>And it was so, that after the LORD had spoken these words unto Job, the LORD said to Eliphaz the Temanite, My wrath is kindled against thee, and against thy two friends: for ye have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job hath.</i> | And it was so, that after the LORD had spoken these words to Job, the LORD said to Eliphaz the Temanite, "My wrath is kindled against You, and against Your two friends; for You have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job has. |

- 8 *Therefore take unto you now seven bullocks and seven rams, and go to my servant Job, and offer up for yourselves a burnt offering; and my servant Job shall pray for you: for him will I accept: lest I deal with you after your folly, in that ye have not spoken of me the thing which is right, like my servant Job.*
- 9 *So Eliphaz the Temanite and Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite went, and did according as the LORD commanded them: the LORD also accepted Job.*
- 10 *And the LORD turned the captivity of Job, when he prayed for his friends: also the LORD gave Job twice as much as he had before.*
- 11 *Then came there unto him all his brethren, and all his sisters, and all they that had been of his acquaintance before, and did eat bread with him in his house: and they bemoaned him, and comforted him over all the evil that the LORD had brought upon him: every man also gave him a piece of money, and every one an earring of gold.*
- 12 *So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning: for he had fourteen thousand sheep, and six thousand camels, and a thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand she asses.*
- 13 *He had also seven sons and three daughters.*
- Therefore take to you now seven bullocks and seven rams, and go to my servant Job, and offer up for yourselves a burnt offering; and my servant Job shall pray for you; for him will I accept; lest I deal with you after your folly, in that you have not spoken of me the thing which is right, like my servant Job."
- So Eliphaz the Temanite and Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite went, and did according as the LORD commanded them; the LORD also accepted Job.
- And the LORD turned the captivity of Job, when he prayed for his friends; also the LORD gave Job twice as much as he had before.
- Then came to Him all His brethren, and all His sisters, and all they that had been of His acquaintance before, and ate bread with Him in His house; and they bemoaned Him, and comforted Him over all the evil that the LORD had brought on Him; every man also gave him a piece of money, and every one an earring of gold.
- So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning; for he had fourteen thousand sheep, and six thousand camels, and a thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand she asses.
- He had also seven sons and three daughters.

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| <p>14 <i>And he called the name of the first, Jemima; and the name of the second, Kezia; and the name of the third, Kerenhappuch.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And in all the land were no women found so fair as the daughters of Job: and their father gave them inheritance among their brethren.</i></p> <p>16 <i>After this lived Job an hundred and forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons' sons, even four generations.</i></p> <p>17 <i>So Job died, being old and full of days.</i></p> | <p>And He called the name of the first, Jemima; and the name of the second, Kezia; and the name of the third, Kerenhappuch.</p> <p>And in all the land were no women found so fair as the daughters of Job; and their father gave them inheritance among their brethren.</p> <p>After this Job lived a hundred and forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons' sons, even four generations.</p> <p>So Job died, being old and full of days.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Matt 19:26; Mark 10:27; Gen 18:14; Heb 4:12-13; Jer 32:17
- v3 — Ps 139:6; Job 38:2; Ps 131:1; Ps 40:5; Prov 30:2-4
- v5 — Eph 1:17-18; Rom 10:17; John 12:45; Isa 6:1; John 12:41
- v6 — Ezra 9:6; Jas 4:7-10; 1 Tim 1:13-16; Job 40:3-4; Dan 9:3
- v7 — Job 32:2-3; Job 11:5-6; Job 32:5; Job 2:11; Job 4:1
- v8 — Num 23:1; Jas 5:16; Ps 103:10; 1 Chr 15:26; Gen 20:17
- v9 — Heb 11:8; Acts 9:6; Acts 10:33; Matt 7:24
- v10 — Deut 30:3; Job 8:6-7; Prov 22:4; Isa 40:2; Isa 61:7
- v11 — Job 2:11; Job 19:13-14; Gen 24:22; Prov 16:7; Heb 12:12
- v12 — Job 8:7; Eccl 7:8; Prov 10:22; Ps 144:13-15; Gen 24:35
- v16 — Prov 17:6; Gen 50:23; Ps 128:6; Gen 25:7; Gen 47:28
- v17 — Gen 25:8; Gen 15:15; Job 5:26; Deut 6:2; Ps 91:16

Psalms

Author: Multiple — David (73 Psalms), Asaph (12), the Sons of Korah (11), Solomon (2), Moses (1 — Psalm 90), Ethan (1 — Psalm 89), and 50 anonymous "orphan" Psalms with no named author.

Date written: c. 1400 BC (Moses, Psalm 90) to the post-exile period c. 500 BC (Psalms 126, 137) — roughly a thousand-year span of worship and prayer.

Written to: Israel for corporate worship; the church for devotion and prayer.

Setting: The Psalter was Israel's hymnal — sung in Temple worship, at pilgrimage festivals, and in personal prayer. The five "books" within the Psalms (1–41, 42–72, 73–89, 90–106, 107–150) mirror the five books of Moses. Each book closes with a doxology, and the entire collection moves from lament toward praise, culminating in the five "Hallelujah" Psalms (146–150).

Where this sits historically: Spans nearly a thousand years — from Moses at Sinai (c. 1400 BC) through David and Solomon's united kingdom (1000–930 BC), the Assyrian and Babylonian crises, and on to the post-exilic return under Persia (c. 500 BC).

Contemporaries: The composers wrote alongside the historical narrative from Joshua to Nehemiah, with later editors gathering the collection during the time of Ezra; many psalms parallel events recorded in 1–2 Samuel and 1–2 Chronicles.

Big themes:

- Praise and worship — the Psalms teach God's people how to praise Him in every season of life
- Lament and honest suffering before God — more than a third of the Psalms are cries of pain, showing that faith does not require pretending
- Trust in the LORD as refuge and fortress — the dominant metaphor of the Psalter
- The kingship of God and the Messianic hope — the "royal Psalms" (2, 45, 72, 110) point to Christ's eternal reign
- Creation declaring God's glory — "The heavens declare the glory of God" (19:1)
- The Torah as light and lamp — Psalm 119, the longest chapter in the Bible, is an extended love poem to God's Word
- Repentance and confession — Psalm 51 is the Bible's greatest prayer of contrition
- God's covenant faithfulness — "His mercy endures forever" is the refrain of Psalm 136 and the heartbeat of the whole collection

Key passages: 1:1–3; 19:1; 22:1; 23; 51:10; 100; 119:105; 139:1–4

How it fits: Psalms is the most-quoted Old Testament book in the New Testament. More Messianic prophecy comes from the Psalms than from any other book. Jesus quoted Psalm 22:1 on the cross — "My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?" — and the early church

sang and prayed the Psalms as its first hymnbook. Every human emotion finds voice here, and every voice finds its way back to God.

Psalm 1

The psalmist celebrates the man who delights in the law of the LORD. The righteous are like a tree planted by streams of water; the ungodly are like chaff driven away by the wind.

1	<i>Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.</i>	Blessed is the man who does not walk in the counsel of the wicked, or stand in the way of sinners, or sit in the seat of mockers.
2	<i>But his delight is in the law of the LORD; and in his law doth he meditate day and night.</i>	But His delight is in the law of the LORD, and on His law He meditates day and night.
3	<i>And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.</i>	He is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither — whatever He does prospers.
4	<i>The ungodly are not so: but are like the chaff which the wind driveth away.</i>	Not so the wicked! They are like chaff that the wind blows away.
5	<i>Therefore the ungodly shall not stand in the judgment, nor sinners in the congregation of the righteous.</i>	Therefore the wicked will not stand in the judgment, nor sinners in the assembly of the righteous.
6	<i>For the LORD knoweth the way of the righteous: but the way of the ungodly shall perish.</i>	For the LORD watches over the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked leads to destruction.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 26:4-5; Prov 4:14-15; Prov 13:20; Ps 119:1-2; Jer 15:17
- v2 — Josh 1:8; Ps 119:92; Ps 119:11; Rom 7:22; Ps 119:97-99
- v3 — Jer 17:8; Ezek 47:12; Ps 92:14; John 15:6; Ezek 19:10
- v4 — Job 21:18; Matt 3:12; Ps 35:5; Isa 17:13; Isa 29:5
- v5 — Ps 5:5; Matt 25:46; Mal 3:18; Matt 25:41; Luke 21:36
- v6 — 2 Tim 2:19; John 10:14; Prov 15:9; Nah 1:7; Ps 37:18-24

Psalm 2

The nations rage against the LORD and His anointed, but God laughs from heaven and declares His King installed on Zion. The psalm warns earthly rulers to kiss the Son and take refuge in Him before His wrath is kindled.

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| 1 | <i>Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing?</i> | Why do the nations rage and the peoples plot in vain? |
| 2 | <i>The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the LORD, and against his anointed, saying,</i> | The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the LORD, and against His anointed, saying, |
| 3 | <i>Let us break their bands asunder, and cast away their cords from us.</i> | "Let us break their chains," they say, "and throw off their shackles." |
| 4 | <i>He that sitteth in the heavens shall laugh: the LORD shall have them in derision.</i> | He who sits in the heavens shall laugh; the Lord shall have them in derision. |
| 5 | <i>Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath, and vex them in his sore displeasure.</i> | Then He rebukes them in His anger and terrifies them in His wrath, saying, |
| 6 | <i>Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion.</i> | "I have installed my King on Zion, my holy mountain." |
| 7 | <i>I will declare the decree: the LORD hath said unto me, Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee.</i> | I will proclaim the LORD's decree: He said to me, "You are my Son; today I have become Your Father. |
| 8 | <i>Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance, and the uttermost parts of the earth for thy possession.</i> | Ask me. I will make the nations your inheritance, the ends of the earth Your possession. |
| 9 | <i>Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel.</i> | You will break them with a rod of iron; You will dash them to pieces like pottery." |
| 10 | <i>Be wise now therefore, O ye kings: be instructed, ye judges of the earth.</i> | Therefore, You kings, be wise; be warned, you rulers of the earth. |
| 11 | <i>Serve the LORD with fear, and rejoice with trembling.</i> | Serve the LORD with fear and celebrate His rule with trembling. |

12

Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and ye perish from the way, when his wrath is kindled but a little. Blessed are all they that put their trust in him.

Kiss His Son, or He will be angry and Your way will lead to Your destruction, for His wrath can flare up in a moment. Blessed are all who take refuge in Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zion** (ZY-on) — God's holy hill in Jerusalem; the place where the LORD set His king (v6). Throughout the Psalms, Zion is the earthly seat of God's reign and a symbol of His eternal kingdom.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 4:25-26; Rev 17:14; Ps 46:6; Ps 21:11; Ps 83:4-8
- v2 — Matt 26:59; Matt 27:1; Rev 17:12-14; Ps 45:7; Luke 23:11-12
- v3 — Jer 5:5; Luke 19:14; 1 Pet 2:7-8; Luke 19:27
- v4 — Ps 37:13; Ps 59:8; Prov 1:26; Isa 40:22; Ps 11:4
- v5 — Isa 11:4; Rev 19:15; Ps 110:5-6; Ps 21:9; Ps 78:49-50
- v6 — Rev 14:1; Matt 28:18; Isa 9:6-7; Eph 1:22; Heb 12:22
- v7 — Heb 5:5; Acts 13:33; Heb 1:5-6; Matt 3:17; Matt 17:5
- v8 — Ps 22:27; Ps 89:27; Ps 72:8; John 17:4-5; Dan 7:13
- v9 — Rev 2:26-27; Rev 12:5; Ps 89:23; Rev 19:15
- v10 — Hos 14:9; Isa 60:10-11
- v11 — Phil 2:12; Heb 12:28-29; Heb 12:25; Ps 119:119-120; Ps 89:7
- v12 — Ps 40:4; John 5:23; Ps 34:8; Ps 84:12; Isa 30:18

Psalm 3

A Psalm of David, when he fled from Absalom his son.

The psalmist cries out to the LORD as enemies multiply against him. He confesses God as his shield and the lifter of his head, and lies down in peace because the LORD sustains him.

1

LORD, how are they increased that trouble me! many are they that rise up against me.

LORD, how many are my foes! How many rise up against me!

■ **NAME NOTE** — **David** (DAY-vid) — "beloved" — King of Israel, "a man after God's own heart" (1 Samuel 13:14). David wrote 73 of the 150 Psalms — more than any other author. He was shepherd, warrior, fugitive, and king, and his songs span every human emotion.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Absalom** (AB-sah-lom) — "father of peace" — David's third son, who led a rebellion against his father and seized the throne by force (2 Samuel 15–18). David fled Jerusalem in grief. Absalom was killed in battle, and David mourned him bitterly.

- 2

Many there be which say of my soul,
There is no help for him in God.
Selah.
- Many there are who say of my soul,
"There is no help for Him in God."
Selah.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Selah** (SEE-lah) — A musical or liturgical pause marker found 71 times in the Psalms. Its exact meaning is uncertain, but it likely signals a pause for reflection, a musical interlude, or a crescendo. When you see "Selah," stop and let the words sink in.

- 3

But thou, O LORD, art a shield for me; my glory, and the lifter up of mine head.
- But You, LORD, are a shield around me, my glory, the One who lifts my head high.
- 4

I cried unto the LORD with my voice, and he heard me out of his holy hill.
Selah.
- I call out to the LORD. He answers me from His holy mountain.
- 5

I laid me down and slept; I awaked; for the LORD sustained me.
- I lie down and sleep; I wake again, because the LORD sustains me.
- 6

I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people, that have set themselves against me round about.
- I will not fear though tens of thousands assail me on every side.
- 7

Arise, O LORD; save me, O my God: for thou hast smitten all mine enemies upon the cheek bone; thou hast broken the teeth of the ungodly.
- Arise, LORD! Deliver me, my God! Strike all my enemies on the jaw; break the teeth of the wicked.
- 8

Salvation belongeth unto the LORD: thy blessing is upon thy people. Selah.
- From the LORD comes deliverance. May Your blessing be on Your people.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 17:7; 2 Sam 17:11-13
- v2 — Ps 71:11; Ps 42:3; Ps 42:10; Ps 22:7; Ps 4:4
- v3 — Ps 27:6; Ps 28:7; Gen 15:1; Ps 119:114; Isa 60:19
- v4 — Ps 34:4; Ps 91:15; Isa 65:24; Ps 34:6; Jer 29:12-13

v5 — Ps 4:8; Prov 3:24; Isa 26:3; Lev 26:6; Job 11:18-19
v6 — Rom 8:31; Ps 27:1-3; Ps 118:10-12; Ps 23:4; 2 Kgs 6:15-17
v7 — Ps 58:6; Job 29:17; Job 16:10; Ps 59:5; Ps 10:12
v8 — Isa 43:11; Jonah 2:9; Ps 37:39-40; Hos 13:4; Rev 7:10

Psalm 4

To the chief Musician on Neginoth. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist calls on God for relief from distress and rebukes those who turn his glory into shame. He declares that the LORD has set apart the godly and lies down in peace, for God alone makes him dwell in safety.

1	<i>Hear me when I call, O God of my righteousness: thou hast enlarged me when I was in distress; have mercy upon me, and hear my prayer.</i>	Answer me when I call to You, my righteous God. Give me relief from my distress; have mercy on me and hear my prayer.
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Neginoth* (NEG-ih-noth) — "stringed instruments." A musical direction in the Psalm title indicating this song was to be accompanied by harps, lyres, or other stringed instruments.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Mercy* (MER-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God withholding the wrath we have earned. In the Psalms, the cry for mercy is the cry of a sinner who knows he has no claim on God except God's own goodness.

2	<i>O ye sons of men, how long will ye turn my glory into shame? how long will ye love vanity, and seek after leasing? Selah.</i>	How long will You people turn my glory into shame? How long will You love delusions and seek false gods?
3	<i>But know that the LORD hath set apart him that is godly for himself: the LORD will hear when I call unto him.</i>	Know that the LORD has set apart His faithful servant for Himself; the LORD hears when I call to Him.
4	<i>Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart upon your bed, and be still. Selah.</i>	Tremble and do not sin; when You are on Your beds, search Your hearts and be silent.
5	<i>Offer the sacrifices of righteousness, and put your trust in the LORD.</i>	Offer the sacrifices of the righteous and trust in the LORD.
6	<i>There be many that say, Who will shew us any good? LORD, lift thou up the light of thy countenance upon us.</i>	There are many who say, "Who will show us any good?" LORD, lift up the light of Your countenance on us.

7	<i>Thou hast put gladness in my heart, more than in the time that their corn and their wine increased.</i>	Fill my heart with joy when their grain and new wine abound.
8	<i>I will both lay me down in peace, and sleep: for thou, LORD, only makest me dwell in safety.</i>	In peace I will lie down and sleep, for You alone, LORD, make me dwell in safety.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 1:10; Ex 34:6-7; Ps 40:1-3; Ps 18:18-19; Ps 119:132
- v2 — Prov 1:22; Hos 4:7; Ps 3:3; Ps 106:20; Jer 2:11
- v3 — John 15:16; Ps 34:15; Ps 91:14-15; 2 Thess 2:13-14; 2 Tim 2:19
- v4 — Eph 4:26; Ps 77:6; Ps 63:6; Prov 3:7; Ps 46:10
- v5 — Heb 13:15-16; Ps 37:3; Ps 51:19; Deut 33:19; Ps 62:8
- v6 — Ps 80:19; Num 6:26; Ps 80:7; Ps 119:135
- v7 — Isa 9:3; Ps 63:2-5; Ps 37:4; Ps 43:4; Acts 14:17
- v8 — Prov 3:24; Ps 3:5; Job 11:18-19; Ps 16:8-9; 1 Thess 5:10

Psalm 5

To the chief Musician upon Nehiloth. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist asks God to hear his morning prayer and lead him in righteousness. He contrasts the wicked, whose throats are open graves, with the righteous who take refuge in God and are surrounded by His favor as with a shield.

1	<i>Give ear to my words, O LORD, consider my meditation.</i>	Listen to my words, LORD, consider my lament.
2	<i>Hearken unto the voice of my cry, my King, and my God: for unto thee will I pray.</i>	Hear my cry for help, my King and my God, for to You I pray.
3	<i>My voice shalt thou hear in the morning, O LORD; in the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee, and will look up.</i>	In the morning, LORD, You hear my voice; in the morning I lay my requests before You and wait expectantly.
4	<i>For thou art not a God that hath pleasure in wickedness: neither shall evil dwell with thee.</i>	For You are not a God Who is pleased with wickedness; with You, evil people are not welcome.

- 5 *The foolish shall not stand in thy sight: thou hatest all workers of iniquity.* The arrogant cannot stand in Your presence. You hate all who do wrong;

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — *Deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin."* Iniquity is the corruption beneath the sinful act — the bent nature that produces evil deeds.

- 6 *Thou shalt destroy them that speak leasing: the LORD will abhor the bloody and deceitful man.* You destroy those who tell lies. The bloodthirsty and deceitful You, LORD, detest.
- 7 *But as for me, I will come into thy house in the multitude of thy mercy: and in thy fear will I worship toward thy holy temple.* But as for me, I will come into Your house in the multitude of Your mercy; and in Your fear I will worship toward Your holy temple.
- 8 *Lead me, O LORD, in thy righteousness because of mine enemies; make thy way straight before my face.* Lead me, LORD, in Your righteousness because of my enemies — make Your way straight before me.
- 9 *For there is no faithfulness in their mouth; their inward part is very wickedness; their throat is an open sepulchre; they flatter with their tongue.* Not a word from their mouth can be trusted; their heart is filled with malice. Their throat is an open grave; with their tongues they tell lies.
- 10 *Destroy thou them, O God; let them fall by their own counsels; cast them out in the multitude of their transgressions; for they have rebelled against thee.* Declare them guilty, O God! Let their intrigues be their downfall. Banish them for their many sins, for they have rebelled against You.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — *Crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command.* Where "iniquity" is the twisted nature, "transgression" is the deliberate act of crossing God's boundary.

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| 11 <i>But let all those that put their trust in thee rejoice: let them ever shout for joy, because thou defendest them: let them also that love thy name be joyful in thee.</i> | But let all who take refuge in You be glad; let them ever sing for joy. Spread Your protection over them, that those who love Your name may rejoice in You. |
| 12 <i>For thou, LORD, wilt bless the righteous; with favour wilt thou compass him as with a shield.</i> | Surely, LORD, You bless the righteous; you surround them with your favor as with a shield. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 John 5:14-15; Ps 54:2; Ps 19:14; 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 55:1-2
- v2 — Ps 65:2; Ps 3:4; Isa 33:22; Ps 145:1
- v3 — Ps 119:147; Ps 88:13; Ps 130:6; Mark 1:35; Ps 55:17
- v4 — Ps 11:5; Heb 12:14; Mal 2:17; Rev 21:27; Ps 50:21
- v5 — Ps 11:5; Hos 9:15; Ps 1:5; Prov 6:16-19; Lev 20:23
- v6 — Ps 55:23; Rev 21:8; Rev 22:15
- v7 — Ps 132:7; Ps 138:2; Heb 4:16; Heb 12:28-29; Ps 69:13
- v8 — Ps 27:11; Ps 25:4-5; Prov 3:5-6; Ps 86:11; Ps 119:10
- v9 — Rom 3:13; Jer 9:3-6; Ps 62:4; Mic 6:12; Prov 29:5
- v10 — Isa 63:10; 2 Sam 17:14; Ps 140:9-10
- v11 — Rom 8:28; Rev 19:1-7; Ps 68:3; Ps 40:16; 1 Cor 2:9
- v12 — Ps 84:11; Ps 32:10; Ps 115:13; Ps 1:1-3; Ps 112:1

Psalm 6

To the chief Musician on Neginoth upon Sheminith. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist pleads with the LORD not to rebuke him in anger, for his bones are troubled and his soul is greatly vexed. He begs God to return and save him for His mercy's sake, weeping on his bed every night.

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| 1 <i>O LORD, rebuke me not in thine anger, neither chasten me in thy hot displeasure.</i> | LORD, do not rebuke me in Your anger or discipline me in Your wrath. |
| 2 <i>Have mercy upon me, O LORD; for I am weak: O LORD, heal me; for my bones are vexed.</i> | Have mercy on me, LORD, for I am faint; heal me, LORD, for my bones are in agony. |

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| 3 | <i>My soul is also sore vexed: but thou, O LORD, how long?</i> | My soul is in deep anguish. How long, LORD, how long? |
| 4 | <i>Return, O LORD, deliver my soul: oh save me for thy mercies' sake.</i> | Turn, LORD, and deliver me; save me because of Your mercy. |
| 5 | <i>For in death there is no remembrance of thee: in the grave who shall give thee thanks?</i> | Among the dead no one proclaims your name. Who praises you from the grave? |
| 6 | <i>I am weary with my groaning; all the night make I my bed to swim; I water my couch with my tears.</i> | I am worn out from my groaning. All night long I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears. |
| 7 | <i>Mine eye is consumed because of grief; it waxeth old because of all mine enemies.</i> | My eyes grow weak with sorrow; they fail because of all my foes. |
| 8 | <i>Depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity; for the LORD hath heard the voice of my weeping.</i> | Away from me, all You who do evil, for the LORD has heard my weeping. |
| 9 | <i>The LORD hath heard my supplication; the LORD will receive my prayer.</i> | The LORD has heard my cry for mercy; the LORD accepts my prayer. |
| 10 | <i>Let all mine enemies be ashamed and sore vexed: let them return and be ashamed suddenly.</i> | All my enemies will be overwhelmed with shame and anguish; they will turn back and suddenly be put to shame. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 38:1; Ps 118:18; Jer 46:28; Jer 10:24; 1 Cor 11:31-32
v2 — Hos 6:1; Ps 31:10; Ps 30:2; Jer 17:14; Deut 32:39
v3 — Ps 90:13
v4 — Dan 9:18
v5 — Ps 88:10-12; Ps 115:17; Eccl 9:10; Ps 30:9; Isa 38:18-19
v6 — Ps 69:3; Ps 42:3; Ps 38:9
v8 — Luke 13:27; Ps 119:115; Ps 145:18; Ps 3:4; Matt 7:23
v9 — Ps 66:19-20; Ps 120:1; 2 Cor 12:8-10; Ps 40:1-2; Ps 138:3
v10 — Jer 20:11; Ps 86:17; Mal 3:18

Psalm 7

Shiggaion of David, which he sang to the LORD, concerning the words of Cush the Benjamite.

The psalmist takes refuge in the LORD from those who pursue him and asks God to arise in judgment. He declares that God is a righteous judge who tests hearts and reins, and gives thanks to the LORD Most High.

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| <p>1 O LORD my God, in thee do I put my trust: save me from all them that persecute me, and deliver me:</p> | <p>LORD my God, I take refuge in You; save and deliver me from all who pursue me,</p> |
| <p>2 Lest he tear my soul like a lion, rending it in pieces, while there is none to deliver.</p> | <p>or they will tear me apart like a lion and rip me to pieces with no one to rescue me.</p> |
| <p>3 O LORD my God, if I have done this; if there be iniquity in my hands;</p> | <p>LORD my God, if I have done this and there is guilt on my hands —</p> |
| <p>4 If I have rewarded evil unto him that was at peace with me; (yea, I have delivered him that without cause is mine enemy:)</p> | <p>if I have repaid my ally with evil or without cause have robbed my foe —</p> |
| <p>5 Let the enemy persecute my soul, and take it; yea, let him tread down my life upon the earth, and lay mine honour in the dust. <i>Selah.</i></p> | <p>then let my enemy pursue and overtake me; let Him trample my life to the ground and make me sleep in the dust.</p> |
| <p>6 Arise, O LORD, in thine anger, lift up thyself because of the rage of mine enemies: and awake for me to the judgment that thou hast commanded.</p> | <p>Arise, LORD, in Your anger; rise up against the rage of my enemies. Awake, my God; decree justice.</p> |
| <p>7 So shall the congregation of the people compass thee about: for their sakes therefore return thou on high.</p> | <p>Let the assembled peoples gather around You, while You sit enthroned over them on high.</p> |
| <p>8 The LORD shall judge the people: judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, and according to mine integrity that is in me.</p> | <p>Let the LORD judge the peoples. Vindicate me, LORD, according to my righteousness, according to my integrity, O Most High.</p> |

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| <p>9 <i>Oh let the wickedness of the wicked come to an end; but establish the just: for the righteous God trieth the hearts and reins.</i></p> <p>10 <i>My defence is of God, which saveth the upright in heart.</i></p> <p>11 <i>God judgeth the righteous, and God is angry with the wicked every day.</i></p> <p>12 <i>If he turn not, he will whet his sword; he hath bent his bow, and made it ready.</i></p> <p>13 <i>He hath also prepared for him the instruments of death; he ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Behold, he travaileth with iniquity, and hath conceived mischief, and brought forth falsehood.</i></p> <p>15 <i>He made a pit, and digged it, and is fallen into the ditch which he made.</i></p> <p>16 <i>His mischief shall return upon his own head, and his violent dealing shall come down upon his own pate.</i></p> <p>17 <i>I will praise the LORD according to his righteousness: and will sing praise to the name of the LORD most high.</i></p> | <p>Bring to an end the violence of the wicked and make the righteous secure — you, the righteous God Who probes minds and hearts.</p> <p>My shield is God Most High, who saves the upright in heart.</p> <p>God is a righteous judge, a God Who displays His wrath every day.</p> <p>If a person does not repent, God will sharpen his sword; He will bend and string his bow.</p> <p>He has prepared his deadly weapons; he makes ready his flaming arrows.</p> <p>Whoever is pregnant with evil conceives trouble and gives birth to disillusionment.</p> <p>Whoever digs a hole and scoops it out falls into the pit they have made.</p> <p>The trouble they cause recoils on them; their violence comes down on their own heads.</p> <p>I will give thanks to the LORD because of His righteousness; I will sing the praises of the name of the LORD Most High.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 31:15; Hab 3:1; 1 Pet 4:19
v2 — Ps 50:22; Isa 38:13; 2 Tim 4:17; 1 Pet 5:8
v6 — Ps 44:23; Ps 35:23; Ps 3:7; Isa 33:10
v8 — Ps 96:13; Rom 14:10-12; Ps 43:1; 2 Cor 1:12; Ps 98:9
v9 — Jer 17:10; Jer 11:20; Jer 20:12; 1 Chr 28:9; 1 Sam 16:7

- v10 — Ps 84:11; Prov 28:18; Ps 125:4; Gen 15:1; Prov 11:20
- v11 — Nah 1:2; Nah 1:6; Ps 7:8
- v12 — Acts 3:19; Matt 3:10; Isa 55:6-7
- v14 — Job 15:35; Jas 1:15; Isa 33:11; Isa 59:4-5; Job 15:20
- v15 — Job 4:8; Ps 141:10; Prov 26:27; Ps 35:7-8; Ps 10:2
- v16 — Esth 9:25; Ps 37:12-13; 1 Kgs 2:32; 1 Sam 28:19; 1 Sam 31:3-4
- v17 — Ps 9:2; Ps 98:2; Ps 71:15-16; Ps 111:3; Ps 92:8

Psalm 8

To the chief Musician upon Gittith. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist marvels at the excellency of God's name in all the earth and asks what man is that God should be mindful of him. God has crowned man with glory and honour and given him dominion over the works of His hands.

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| 1 | <i>O LORD our Lord, how excellent is thy name in all the earth! who hast set thy glory above the heavens.</i> | LORD, our Lord, how majestic is Your name in all the earth! You have set Your glory in the heavens. |
| 2 | <i>Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings hast thou ordained strength because of thine enemies, that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.</i> | Through the praise of children and infants You have established a stronghold against Your enemies, to silence the foe and the avenger. |
| 3 | <i>When I consider thy heavens, the work of thy fingers, the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained;</i> | When I consider Your heavens, the work of Your fingers, the moon and the stars, which You have set in place, |
| 4 | <i>What is man, that thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that thou visitest him?</i> | what is man, that You are mindful of Him? And the son of man, that You visit Him? |
| 5 | <i>For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned him with glory and honour.</i> | For You have made Him a little lower than the angels and crowned Him with glory and honor. |
| 6 | <i>Thou madest him to have dominion over the works of thy hands; thou hast put all things under his feet:</i> | You made Him to have dominion over the works of Your hands; You have put all things under His feet: |
| 7 | <i>All sheep and oxen, yea, and the beasts of the field;</i> | all flocks and herds, and the animals of the wild, |

8	<i>The fowl of the air, and the fish of the sea, and whatsoever passeth through the paths of the seas.</i>	the birds in the sky, and the fish in the sea, all that swim the paths of the seas.
9	<i>O LORD our Lord, how excellent is thy name in all the earth!</i>	LORD, our Lord, how majestic is Your name in all the earth!

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 8:9; Ps 113:2-4; Ps 57:5; Ps 148:13; Ex 15:11
- v2 — Matt 21:16; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Isa 40:31; 1 Cor 1:27; Ps 46:10
- v3 — Gen 1:1; Ps 33:6; Ps 89:11; Ps 104:19; Ps 111:2
- v4 — Job 7:17; Ps 144:3; Heb 2:6-9; Ps 146:3; Luke 1:68
- v5 — Heb 2:7; Heb 2:9; Gen 1:26-27; Heb 2:16; Phil 2:7-11
- v6 — Gen 1:28; Gen 1:26; Heb 2:8; Matt 28:18; Eph 1:22
- v7 — Gen 2:20
- v9 — Ps 8:1

Psalm 9

To the chief Musician upon Muthlabben. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist praises God with his whole heart and recounts how his enemies turned back and perished. He declares that the LORD reigns forever, judges the world in righteousness, and is a refuge for the oppressed in times of trouble.

1	<i>I will praise thee, O LORD, with my whole heart; I will shew forth all thy marvellous works.</i>	I will give thanks to You, LORD, with all my heart; I will tell of all Your wonderful deeds.
2	<i>I will be glad and rejoice in thee: I will sing praise to thy name, O thou most High.</i>	I will be glad and rejoice in You; I will sing the praises of Your name, O Most High.
3	<i>When mine enemies are turned back, they shall fall and perish at thy presence.</i>	My enemies turn back; they stumble and perish before You.
4	<i>For thou hast maintained my right and my cause; thou satest in the throne judging right.</i>	For You have upheld my right and my cause, sitting enthroned as the righteous judge.

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| 5 <i>Thou hast rebuked the heathen, thou hast destroyed the wicked, thou hast put out their name for ever and ever.</i> | You have rebuked the nations and destroyed the wicked; you have blotted out their name for ever and ever. |
| 6 <i>O thou enemy, destructions are come to a perpetual end: and thou hast destroyed cities; their memorial is perished with them.</i> | Endless ruin has overtaken my enemies; you have uprooted their cities — even the memory of them has perished. |
| 7 <i>But the LORD shall endure for ever: he hath prepared his throne for judgment.</i> | The LORD reigns forever; He has established His throne for judgment. |
| 8 <i>And he shall judge the world in righteousness, he shall minister judgment to the people in uprightness.</i> | He rules the world in righteousness and judges the peoples with equity. |
| 9 <i>The LORD also will be a refuge for the oppressed, a refuge in times of trouble.</i> | The LORD is a refuge for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble. |
| 10 <i>And they that know thy name will put their trust in thee: for thou, LORD, hast not forsaken them that seek thee.</i> | Those who know Your name trust in You, for You, LORD, have never forsaken those who seek You. |
| 11 <i>Sing praises to the LORD, which dwelleth in Zion: declare among the people his doings.</i> | Sing the praises of the LORD, enthroned in Zion; proclaim among the nations what he has done. |
| 12 <i>When he maketh inquisition for blood, he remembereth them: he forgetteth not the cry of the humble.</i> | For He who avenges blood remembers; he does not ignore the cries of the afflicted. |
| 13 <i>Have mercy upon me, O LORD; consider my trouble which I suffer of them that hate me, thou that liftest me up from the gates of death:</i> | LORD, see how my enemies persecute me! Have mercy and lift me up from the gates of death, |
| 14 <i>That I may shew forth all thy praise in the gates of the daughter of Zion: I will rejoice in thy salvation.</i> | that I may show forth all Your praise in the gates of the daughter of Zion; I will rejoice in Your salvation. |

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| <p>15 <i>The heathen are sunk down in the pit that they made: in the net which they hid is their own foot taken.</i></p> <p>16 <i>The LORD is known by the judgment which he executeth: the wicked is snared in the work of his own hands. Higgaion. Selah.</i></p> <p>17 <i>The wicked shall be turned into hell, and all the nations that forget God.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For the needy shall not alway be forgotten: the expectation of the poor shall not perish for ever.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Arise, O LORD; let not man prevail: let the heathen be judged in thy sight.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Put them in fear, O LORD: that the nations may know themselves to be but men. Selah.</i></p> | <p>The nations have fallen into the pit they have dug; their feet are caught in the net they have hidden.</p> <p>The LORD is known by His acts of justice; the wicked are ensnared by the work of their hands.</p> <p>The wicked go down to the hell, all the nations that forget God.</p> <p>But God will never forget the needy; the hope of the afflicted will never perish.</p> <p>Arise, LORD; do not let man prevail; let the nations be judged in your sight.</p> <p>Put them in fear, LORD, that the nations may know themselves to be but men. Selah.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 86:12; 1 Chr 16:24; Ps 145:1-3; Ps 103:1-2; Ps 111:1
- v2** — Ps 83:18; Ps 5:11; Ps 7:17; Ps 28:7; Ps 97:9
- v4** — Ps 140:12; 1 Pet 2:23; Ps 98:9; Isa 11:4; Ps 47:8
- v5** — Prov 10:7; Rev 19:15; Mal 4:3; Prov 13:9; Deut 9:14
- v8** — Ps 96:13; Rev 20:12-13; Acts 17:31; Ps 98:9
- v9** — Prov 18:10; Ps 91:1-2; Nah 1:7; Ps 32:7; Ps 46:1
- v10** — Ps 91:14; Prov 18:10; Isa 26:3-4; Ps 105:3-4; 2 Cor 1:9-10
- v11** — Ps 107:22; Ps 148:1-5; Ps 96:1-2; Ps 66:2; Isa 12:4-6
- v12** — Ps 34:6; Ex 3:7; Rev 16:6; Rev 6:9-10; Gen 9:5
- v15** — Ps 57:6; Prov 5:22; Ps 35:8; Ps 7:15-16; Prov 22:8
- v17** — Rev 21:8; Ps 50:22; 2 Thess 1:7-9; Rom 2:8-9; Job 8:13
- v18** — Ps 12:5; Prov 23:18; Jas 2:5; Prov 24:14; Luke 1:53

Psalm 10

The psalmist asks why the LORD stands far off while the wicked devour the poor. He describes the arrogant man who says in his heart that God has forgotten, then calls on the LORD to

arise, break the arm of the wicked, and defend the fatherless and oppressed.

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| <p>1 <i>Why standest thou afar off, O LORD?
why hidest thou thyself in times of
trouble?</i></p> | <p>Why, LORD, do You stand far off?
Why do You hide Yourself in times of
trouble?</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The wicked in his pride doth persecute
the poor: let them be taken in the
devices that they have imagined.</i></p> | <p>In his arrogance the wicked man hunts
down the weak, who are caught in the
schemes he devises.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For the wicked boasteth of his heart's
desire, and blesseth the covetous,
whom the LORD abhorreth.</i></p> | <p>He boasts about the cravings of His
heart; He blesses the greedy and
reviles the LORD.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The wicked, through the pride of his
countenance, will not seek after God:
God is not in all his thoughts.</i></p> | <p>In his pride the wicked man does not
seek him; in all his thoughts there is no
room for God.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>His ways are always grievous; thy
judgments are far above out of his
sight: as for all his enemies, he
puffeth at them.</i></p> | <p>His ways are always prosperous; your
laws are rejected by him; he sneers at
all his enemies.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>He hath said in his heart, I shall not
be moved: for I shall never be in
adversity.</i></p> | <p>He says to himself, "Nothing will ever
shake me." He swears, "No one will
ever do me harm."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>His mouth is full of cursing and deceit
and fraud: under his tongue is
mischief and vanity.</i></p> | <p>His mouth is full of lies and threats;
trouble and evil are under his tongue.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>He sitteth in the lurking places of the
villages: in the secret places doth he
murder the innocent: his eyes are
privily set against the poor.</i></p> | <p>He lies in wait near the villages; from
ambush he murders the innocent. His
eyes watch in secret for his victims;</p> |
| <p>9 <i>He lieth in wait secretly as a lion in
his den: he lieth in wait to catch the
poor: he doth catch the poor, when he
draweth him into his net.</i></p> | <p>like a lion in cover he lies in wait. He
lies in wait to catch the helpless; he
catches the helpless and drags them off
in his net.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>He croucheth, and humbleth himself,
that the poor may fall by his strong
ones.</i></p> | <p>His victims are crushed, they collapse;
they fall under his strength.</p> |

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| <p>11 <i>He hath said in his heart, God hath forgotten: he hideth his face; he will never see it.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Arise, O LORD; O God, lift up thine hand: forget not the humble.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Wherefore doth the wicked contemn God? he hath said in his heart, Thou wilt not require it.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Thou hast seen it; for thou beholdest mischief and spite, to requite it with thy hand: the poor committeth himself unto thee; thou art the helper of the fatherless.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Break thou the arm of the wicked and the evil man: seek out his wickedness till thou find none.</i></p> <p>16 <i>The LORD is King for ever and ever: the heathen are perished out of his land.</i></p> <p>17 <i>LORD, thou hast heard the desire of the humble: thou wilt prepare their heart, thou wilt cause thine ear to hear:</i></p> <p>18 <i>To judge the fatherless and the oppressed, that the man of the earth may no more oppress.</i></p> | <p>He says to himself, "God will never notice; He covers His face and never sees."</p> <p>Arise, LORD! Lift up Your hand, O God. Do not forget the helpless.</p> <p>Why does the wicked man revile God? Why does He say to himself, "He won't call me to account"?</p> <p>But You, God, see the trouble of the afflicted; You consider their grief and take it in hand. The victims commit themselves to You; You are the helper of the fatherless.</p> <p>Break the arm of the wicked man; call the evildoer to account for his wickedness that would not otherwise be found out.</p> <p>The LORD is King for ever and ever; the nations will perish from his land.</p> <p>You, LORD, hear the desire of the afflicted; You encourage them, and You listen to their cry,</p> <p>to judge the fatherless and the oppressed, that the man of the earth may no longer oppress.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 22:1; Ps 27:9; Ps 13:1-3; Jer 14:8; Ps 44:24
- v2 — Ps 59:12; Ps 36:11; Ps 7:16; Prov 5:22; Ps 31:18
- v3 — Ps 94:4; Luke 12:19; Zech 11:5-8
- v4 — Ps 14:1-2; Rom 1:28; Acts 8:22; Gen 6:5
- v9 — Ps 17:12; Ps 59:3

- v11 — Ezek 8:12; Ps 94:7
- v12 — Mic 5:9; Ps 9:12
- v14 — Ps 68:5; Ps 146:9
- v15 — Ps 37:17; Job 38:15; Zeph 1:12; Ps 7:9
- v16 — Jer 10:10; Ps 29:10
- v17 — Ps 145:19; 2 Chr 34:27; Ps 34:15; 1 Pet 3:12; Isa 65:24
- v18 — Ps 9:9; Ps 82:3

Psalm 11

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares his trust in the LORD when told to flee like a bird. He affirms that the LORD is in His holy temple, His eyes test the children of men, and He rains snares on the wicked while the righteous behold His face.

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| 1 | <i>In the LORD put I my trust: how say ye to my soul, Flee as a bird to your mountain?</i> | In the LORD I take refuge. How then can You say to me: "Flee like a bird to Your mountain. |
| 2 | <i>For, lo, the wicked bend their bow, they make ready their arrow upon the string, that they may privily shoot at the upright in heart.</i> | For look, the wicked bend their bows; they set their arrows against the strings to shoot from the shadows at the upright in heart. |
| 3 | <i>If the foundations be destroyed, what can the righteous do?</i> | When the foundations are being destroyed, what can the righteous do?" |
| 4 | <i>The LORD is in his holy temple, the LORD'S throne is in heaven: his eyes behold, his eyelids try, the children of men.</i> | The LORD is in His holy temple; the LORD is on His heavenly throne. He observes everyone on earth; His eyes examine them. |
| 5 | <i>The LORD trieth the righteous: but the wicked and him that loveth violence his soul hateth.</i> | The LORD examines the righteous, but the wicked, those who love violence, he hates with a passion. |
| 6 | <i>Upon the wicked he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, and an horrible tempest: this shall be the portion of their cup.</i> | On the wicked he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, and a horrible tempest; this shall be the portion of their cup. |

7	<i>For the righteous LORD loveth righteousness; his countenance doth behold the upright.</i>	For the righteous LORD loves righteousness; His countenance looks on the upright.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 56:11; Isa 26:3-4; 1 Sam 23:14; Ps 25:2; Luke 13:31
- v2 — Ps 64:3-5; Ps 21:12; Ps 37:14; Jer 9:3
- v3 — Ps 82:5; 2 Tim 2:19; Isa 58:12; Ps 75:3; Acts 4:24-33
- v4 — Ps 103:19; Ps 18:6; Ps 2:4; Hab 2:20; Ps 34:15-16
- v5 — Prov 6:16-19; Jas 1:12; Ps 7:9; Ps 21:8; Ps 5:4-5
- v6 — Ezek 38:22; Gen 19:24; Luke 17:29; Ezek 13:13; Ps 75:8
- v7 — Rev 22:4; Ps 17:15; 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 45:7; Job 36:7

Psalm 12

To the chief Musician upon Sheminith. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist cries for help because the godly are vanishing and the faithful are failing among men. Liars and flatterers fill the earth, but the LORD promises to arise and protect the poor, for His words are pure as silver tried seven times.

1	<i>Help, LORD; for the godly man ceaseth; for the faithful fail from among the children of men.</i>	Help, LORD, for the godly man ceases; for the faithful fail from among the children of men.
2	<i>They speak vanity every one with his neighbour: with flattering lips and with a double heart do they speak.</i>	Everyone lies to their neighbor; they flatter with their lips but harbor deception in their hearts.
3	<i>The LORD shall cut off all flattering lips, and the tongue that speaketh proud things:</i>	May the LORD silence all flattering lips and every boastful tongue —
4	<i>Who have said, With our tongue will we prevail; our lips are our own: who is lord over us?</i>	those who say, "By our tongues we will prevail; our own lips will defend us — who is lord over us?"
5	<i>For the oppression of the poor, for the sighing of the needy, now will I arise, saith the LORD; I will set him in safety from him that puffeth at him.</i>	"Because the poor are plundered and the needy groan, I will now arise," says the LORD. "I will protect them from those who malign them."

6	<i>The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.</i>	the words of the LORD are flawless, like silver purified in a crucible, like gold refined seven times.
7	<i>Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.</i>	You, LORD, will keep the needy safe and will protect us forever from the wicked,
8	<i>The wicked walk on every side, when the vilest men are exalted.</i>	The wicked walk on every side when the vilest men are exalted.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 57:1; Jer 5:1; Matt 24:12; Isa 59:13-15; Isa 1:21-22
- v2 — Rom 16:18; Jer 9:8; Ps 41:6; Ps 10:7; Ps 5:9
- v3 — Prov 18:21; Dan 7:8; Rev 13:5
- v4 — Jas 3:5-6; Job 21:14-15; 2 Thess 2:4; Ex 5:2; Jer 18:18
- v5 — Ps 34:6; Prov 14:31; Jas 5:4; Ps 146:7-8; Isa 33:10
- v6 — Prov 30:5; Ps 18:30; 2 Sam 22:31; Ps 19:8; Ps 66:10
- v7 — 1 Sam 2:9
- v8 — Mark 14:63-65; Ps 55:10-11

Psalm 13

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist cries "How long?" four times, pleading with the LORD not to forget him. He moves from desperate lament to trust in God's mercy and closes singing praise because the LORD has dealt bountifully with him.

1	<i>How long wilt thou forget me, O LORD? for ever? how long wilt thou hide thy face from me?</i>	How long, LORD? Will You forget me forever? How long will You hide Your face from me?
2	<i>How long shall I take counsel in my soul, having sorrow in my heart daily? how long shall mine enemy be exalted over me?</i>	How long must I wrestle with my thoughts and day after day have sorrow in my heart? How long will my enemy triumph over me?
3	<i>Consider and hear me, O LORD my God: lighten mine eyes, lest I sleep the sleep of death;</i>	Look on me and answer, LORD my God. Give light to my eyes, or I will sleep in death,

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| 4 | <i>Lest mine enemy say, I have prevailed against him; and those that trouble me rejoice when I am moved.</i> | my enemy will say, "I have overcome Him," and my foes will rejoice when I fall. |
| 5 | <i>But I have trusted in thy mercy; my heart shall rejoice in thy salvation.</i> | But I trust in Your mercy; my heart rejoices in Your salvation. |
| 6 | <i>I will sing unto the LORD, because he hath dealt bountifully with me.</i> | I will sing the LORD's praise, for He has been good to me. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 13:24; Lam 5:20; Ps 89:46; Ps 94:3-4; Ps 22:1-2
- v2 — Mic 7:8-10; Jer 8:18; Jer 15:18
- v3 — Ezra 9:8; Ps 18:28; Jer 51:39; Ps 5:1; 1 Sam 14:29
- v4 — Ps 25:2; Jer 1:19; Prov 12:3
- v5 — Jude 1:21; Isa 12:2; Hab 3:18; Ps 52:8; Ps 51:12
- v6 — Ps 116:7; Ps 21:13; Ps 119:7

Psalm 14

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares that the fool says in his heart there is no God. The LORD looks down from heaven and finds that all have turned aside -- there is none that does good, not even one. He longs for the salvation of Israel to come out of Zion.

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| 1 | <i>The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. They are corrupt, they have done abominable works, there is none that doeth good.</i> | The fool says in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt, their deeds are vile; there is no one who does good. |
| 2 | <i>The LORD looked down from heaven upon the children of men, to see if there were any that did understand, and seek God.</i> | The LORD looks down from heaven on all mankind to see if there are any who understand, any who seek God. |
| 3 | <i>They are all gone aside, they are all together become filthy: there is none that doeth good, no, not one.</i> | All have turned away, all have become corrupt; there is no one who does good, not even one. |

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| 4 <i>Have all the workers of iniquity no knowledge? who eat up my people as they eat bread, and call not upon the LORD.</i> | Do all these evildoers know nothing? They devour my people as though eating bread; they never call on the LORD. |
| 5 <i>There were they in great fear: for God is in the generation of the righteous.</i> | But there they are, overwhelmed with dread, for God is present in the company of the righteous. |
| 6 <i>Ye have shamed the counsel of the poor, because the LORD is his refuge.</i> | You evildoers frustrate the plans of the poor. But The LORD is their refuge. |
| 7 <i>Oh that the salvation of Israel were come out of Zion! when the LORD bringeth back the captivity of his people, Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.</i> | Oh, that salvation for Israel would come out of Zion! When the LORD restores His people, let Jacob rejoice and Israel be glad! |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 10:4; Ps 53:1; Rom 3:10-12; Rom 1:21-32; Ps 92:6
- v2 — Rom 3:11; Ps 33:13-14; Heb 11:6; Ps 102:19-20; Gen 6:12
- v3 — Rom 3:10-12; Isa 53:6; Isa 64:6; Rom 3:23; Ps 14:1
- v4 — Ps 79:6; Jer 10:25; Ps 82:5; Isa 64:7; Rom 1:28
- v5 — Ps 112:2; Ps 73:15; Ps 24:6
- v7 — Ps 53:6

Psalm 15

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist asks who may dwell in the LORD's tabernacle and on His holy hill. The answer is the one who walks uprightly, speaks truth, does no evil to his neighbor, keeps his oath even when it hurts, and takes no bribe against the innocent.

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| 1 <i>LORD, who shall abide in thy tabernacle? who shall dwell in thy holy hill?</i> | LORD, who may dwell in Your sacred tent? Who may live on Your holy mountain? |
| 2 <i>He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness, and speaketh the truth in his heart.</i> | The one whose walk is blameless, who does what is righteous, who speaks the truth from their heart; |

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| 3 <i>He that backbiteth not with his tongue, nor doeth evil to his neighbour, nor taketh up a reproach against his neighbour.</i> | whose tongue utters no slander, who does no wrong to a neighbor, and casts no slur on others; |
| 4 <i>In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not.</i> | who despises a vile person but honors those who fear the LORD; who keeps an oath even when it hurts, and does not change their mind; |
| 5 <i>He that putteth not out his money to usury, nor taketh reward against the innocent. He that doeth these things shall never be moved.</i> | who lends money to the poor without interest; who does not accept a bribe against the innocent. Whoever does these things will never be shaken. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 24:3-5; Ps 84:4; Ps 61:4; Ps 92:13; Ps 23:6
- v2 — Prov 28:18; Eph 4:25; Col 3:9; Prov 2:7-8; Ps 34:12-13
- v3 — Rom 13:10; Ps 101:5-8; Jas 4:11; Matt 7:12; Lev 19:16
- v4 — Judg 11:35; Matt 5:33; Ps 101:6
- v5 — Ex 22:25; Deut 16:19; Ezek 22:12; Ezek 18:8; Deut 23:19-20

Psalm 16

Michtam of David.

The psalmist trusts God as his refuge and portion, declaring that the LORD is always at his right hand. He rejoices that God will not leave his soul in hell nor allow His Holy One to see corruption -- a psalm the apostles applied directly to the resurrection of Christ.

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| 1 <i>Preserve me, O God: for in thee do I put my trust.</i> | Keep me safe, my God, for in You I take refuge. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Michtam** (MIK-tam) — A Psalm title of uncertain meaning, possibly "golden poem" or "engraved writing." It appears in six Psalm titles (16, 56–60) and may indicate a poem of special significance or permanence.

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| 2 <i>O my soul, thou hast said unto the LORD, Thou art my Lord: my goodness extendeth not to thee;</i> | I say to the LORD, "You are my Lord; apart from You I have no good thing." |
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| 3 | <i>But to the saints that are in the earth, and to the excellent, in whom is all my delight.</i> | I say of the holy people who are in the land, "They are the noble ones in whom is all my delight." |
| 4 | <i>Their sorrows shall be multiplied that hasten after another god: their drink offerings of blood will I not offer, nor take up their names into my lips.</i> | Those who run after other gods will suffer more and more. I will not pour out libations of blood to such gods or take up their names on my lips. |
| 5 | <i>The LORD is the portion of mine inheritance and of my cup: thou maintainest my lot.</i> | LORD, You alone are my portion and my cup; You make my lot secure. |
| 6 | <i>The lines are fallen unto me in pleasant places; yea, I have a goodly heritage.</i> | The boundary lines have fallen for me in pleasant places; surely I have a delightful inheritance. |
| 7 | <i>I will bless the LORD, who hath given me counsel: my reins also instruct me in the night seasons.</i> | I will praise the LORD, Who counsels me; even at night my heart instructs me. |
| 8 | <i>I have set the LORD always before me: because he is at my right hand, I shall not be moved.</i> | I keep my eyes always on the LORD. With Him at my right hand, I will not be shaken. |
| 9 | <i>Therefore my heart is glad, and my glory rejoiceth: my flesh also shall rest in hope.</i> | Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body also will rest secure, |
| 10 | <i>For thou wilt not leave my soul in hell; neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.</i> | For You will not leave my soul in hell; neither will You allow Your Holy One to see corruption. |
| 11 | <i>Thou wilt shew me the path of life: in thy presence is fulness of joy; at thy right hand there are pleasures for evermore.</i> | You make known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 26:3-4; Ps 31:23; Ps 56:1; Ps 17:8; 2 Tim 1:12

v2 — Ps 73:25; Ps 31:14; Ps 89:26; Ps 91:2; Job 22:2-3

v3 — Heb 6:10; Prov 13:20; Prov 12:26; 2 Chr 6:41
v4 — Ex 23:13; Josh 23:7; Ps 32:10; Ps 97:7; Jonah 2:8
v5 — Ps 73:26; Ps 142:5; Lam 3:24; Ps 23:5; Ps 119:57
v6 — Jer 3:19; Ps 78:55; Eph 1:18; Heb 12:2; Ps 21:1-3
v7 — Ps 73:24; Ps 17:3; Ps 63:6; Isa 50:4; Ps 77:6
v8 — Ps 62:6; Acts 2:25-28; Ps 121:5; Ps 73:23; Ps 73:26
v9 — Acts 2:26; Ps 30:12; Ps 57:8; Ps 4:7-8; Ps 108:1
v10 — Acts 2:27-31; Acts 13:35-38; Ps 49:15; Rev 1:18; Rev 20:13
v11 — Acts 2:28; Jude 1:24; Ps 36:7-8; Rev 7:15-17; Eph 3:19

Psalm 17

A Prayer of David.

The psalmist pleads for the LORD to hear his righteous cause and examine his heart. He prays for deliverance from the wicked who surround him like a lion crouching to spring, and asks God to arise, confront them, and satisfy him with His likeness when he awakes.

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| 1 | <i>Hear the right, O LORD, attend unto my cry, give ear unto my prayer, that goeth not out of feigned lips.</i> | Hear me, LORD, my plea is just; listen to my cry. Hear my prayer — it does not rise from deceitful lips. |
| 2 | <i>Let my sentence come forth from thy presence; let thine eyes behold the things that are equal.</i> | Let my vindication come from You; may Your eyes see what is right. |
| 3 | <i>Thou hast proved mine heart; thou hast visited me in the night; thou hast tried me, and shalt find nothing; I am purposed that my mouth shall not transgress.</i> | Though You probe my heart, though You examine me at night and test me, You will find that I have planned no evil; my mouth has not transgressed. |
| 4 | <i>Concerning the works of men, by the word of thy lips I have kept me from the paths of the destroyer.</i> | As for what others do — by the word of Your lips I have kept myself from the ways of the violent. |
| 5 | <i>Hold up my goings in thy paths, that my footsteps slip not.</i> | My steps have held to Your paths; my feet have not stumbled. |
| 6 | <i>I have called upon thee, for thou wilt hear me, O God: incline thine ear unto me, and hear my speech.</i> | I call on You, my God, for You will answer me; turn Your ear to me and hear my prayer. |

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| 7 <i>Shew thy marvellous lovingkindness,
O thou that savest by thy right hand
them which put their trust in thee from
those that rise up against them.</i> | 7 Show Your marvellous
lovingkindness, O You who save by
Your right hand those who put their
trust in You from those who rise up
against them. |
| 8 <i>Keep me as the apple of the eye, hide
me under the shadow of thy wings,</i> | 8 Keep me as the apple of Your eye; hide
me in the shadow of Your wings |
| 9 <i>From the wicked that oppress me,
from my deadly enemies, who
compass me about.</i> | 9 from the wicked who are out to destroy
me, from my mortal enemies who
surround me. |
| 10 <i>They are inclosed in their own fat:
with their mouth they speak proudly.</i> | 10 They close up their callous hearts.
Their mouths speak with arrogance. |
| 11 <i>They have now compassed us in our
steps: they have set their eyes bowing
down to the earth;</i> | 11 They have tracked me down, they now
surround me, with eyes alert, to throw
me to the ground. |
| 12 <i>Like as a lion that is greedy of his
prey, and as it were a young lion
lurking in secret places.</i> | 12 They are like a lion hungry for prey,
like a fierce lion crouching in cover. |
| 13 <i>Arise, O LORD, disappoint him, cast
him down: deliver my soul from the
wicked, which is thy sword:</i> | 13 Rise up, LORD, confront them, bring
them down; with Your sword rescue
me from the wicked. |
| 14 <i>From men which are thy hand, O
LORD, from men of the world, which
have their portion in this life, and
whose belly thou fillest with thy hid
treasure: they are full of children, and
leave the rest of their substance to
their babes.</i> | 14 By Your hand save me from such
people, LORD, from those of this
world whose reward is in this life. May
what You have stored up for the
wicked fill their bellies; may their
children gorge themselves on it, and
may there be leftovers for their little
ones. |
| 15 <i>As for me, I will behold thy face in
righteousness: I shall be satisfied,
when I awake, with thy likeness.</i> | 15 As for me, I will be vindicated and will
see Your face; when I awake, I will be
satisfied with seeing Your likeness. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 142:6; Ps 61:1; Ps 145:18; 1 John 3:21; Matt 15:8
- v2 — Ps 37:6; 2 Thess 1:6-9; Ezek 18:29; Ezek 18:25
- v3 — Job 23:10; Acts 11:23; Ps 26:2; Ps 39:1; Mal 3:2
- v4 — Ps 119:9-11; 1 Cor 3:3; 1 Pet 5:8
- v5 — Ps 44:18; Ps 119:133; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 121:7; Ps 18:36
- v6 — Ps 116:2; Ps 86:7; Ps 88:2; Ps 66:19-20; Ps 55:16
- v7 — Ps 60:5; Ps 31:21; Ps 20:6; Ps 5:11-12; Isa 41:10
- v8 — Deut 32:10; Ps 91:4; Ps 91:1; Prov 7:2; Ps 61:4
- v10 — 1 Sam 2:3; Ps 123:4; Ps 31:18
- v13 — Ps 3:7; Ps 44:26; Ps 7:6
- v14 — Job 22:18; John 17:14; Luke 12:19-21; John 15:19; Luke 16:8
- v15 — 2 Cor 3:18; Ps 11:7; Ps 16:11; Matt 5:6; Ps 4:6-7

Psalm 18

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David, the servant of the LORD, who spoke to the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD delivered him from the hand of all his enemies, and from the hand of Saul.

The psalmist praises the LORD as his rock, fortress, and deliverer after being rescued from all his enemies. He recounts how God shook the earth, parted the heavens, and rode on a cherub to save him, and declares that the LORD lives and is worthy to be praised among the nations.

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| 1 | <i>I will love thee, O LORD, my strength.</i> | I love You, LORD, my strength. |
| 2 | <i>The LORD is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer; my God, my strength, in whom I will trust; my buckler, and the horn of my salvation, and my high tower.</i> | The LORD is my rock, my fortress and my deliverer; my God is my rock, in whom I take refuge, my shield and the horn of my salvation, my stronghold. |
| 3 | <i>I will call upon the LORD, who is worthy to be praised: so shall I be saved from mine enemies.</i> | I called to the LORD, Who is worthy of praise. I have been saved from my enemies. |
| 4 | <i>The sorrows of death compassed me, and the floods of ungodly men made me afraid.</i> | The cords of death entangled me; the torrents of destruction overwhelmed me. |
| 5 | <i>The sorrows of hell compassed me about: the snares of death prevented me.</i> | The cords of the grave coiled around me; the snares of death confronted me. |

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| 6 | <i>In my distress I called upon the LORD, and cried unto my God: he heard my voice out of his temple, and my cry came before him, even into his ears.</i> | In my distress I called to the LORD; I cried to my God for help. From His temple He heard my voice; my cry came before Him, into His ears. |
| 7 | <i>Then the earth shook and trembled; the foundations also of the hills moved and were shaken, because he was wroth.</i> | The earth trembled and quaked, and the foundations of the mountains shook; they trembled because He was angry. |
| 8 | <i>There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.</i> | Smoke rose from his nostrils; consuming fire came from His mouth, burning coals blazed out of it. |
| 9 | <i>He bowed the heavens also, and came down: and darkness was under his feet.</i> | He parted the heavens and came down; dark clouds were under His feet. |
| 10 | <i>And he rode upon a cherub, and did fly: yea, he did fly upon the wings of the wind.</i> | He mounted the cherubim and flew; He soared on the wings of the wind. |
| 11 | <i>He made darkness his secret place; his pavilion round about him were dark waters and thick clouds of the skies.</i> | He made darkness His covering, His canopy around Him — the dark rain clouds of the sky. |
| 12 | <i>At the brightness that was before him his thick clouds passed, hail stones and coals of fire.</i> | Out of the brightness of His presence clouds advanced, with hailstones and bolts of lightning. |
| 13 | <i>The LORD also thundered in the heavens, and the Highest gave his voice; hail stones and coals of fire.</i> | The LORD thundered from heaven; the voice of the Most High resounded. |
| 14 | <i>Yea, he sent out his arrows, and scattered them; and he shot out lightnings, and discomfited them.</i> | He shot his arrows and scattered the enemy, with great bolts of lightning he routed them. |

- 15 *Then the channels of waters were seen, and the foundations of the world were discovered at thy rebuke, O LORD, at the blast of the breath of thy nostrils.* The valleys of the sea were exposed and the foundations of the earth laid bare at Your rebuke, LORD, at the blast of breath from Your nostrils.
- 16 *He sent from above, he took me, he drew me out of many waters.* He reached down from on high and took hold of me; He drew me out of deep waters.
- 17 *He delivered me from my strong enemy, and from them which hated me: for they were too strong for me.* He rescued me from my powerful enemy, from my foes, who were too strong for me.
- 18 *They prevented me in the day of my calamity: but the LORD was my stay.* They confronted me in the day of my disaster. But The LORD was my support.
- 19 *He brought me forth also into a large place; he delivered me, because he delighted in me.* He brought me out into a spacious place; He rescued me because He delighted in me.
- 20 *The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.* The LORD has dealt with me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands He has rewarded me.
- 21 *For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.* For I have kept the ways of the LORD; I am not guilty of turning from my God.
- 22 *For all his judgments were before me, and I did not put away his statutes from me.* All His laws are before me; I have not turned away from His decrees.
- 23 *I was also upright before him, and I kept myself from mine iniquity.* I have been blameless before Him and have kept myself from sin.
- 24 *Therefore hath the LORD recompensed me according to my righteousness, according to the cleanness of my hands in his eyesight.* The LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, according to the cleanness of my hands in His sight.

- 25 *With the merciful thou wilt shew thyself merciful; with an upright man thou wilt shew thyself upright;* To the faithful You show Yourself faithful, to the blameless You show Yourself blameless,
- 26 *With the pure thou wilt shew thyself pure; and with the froward thou wilt shew thyself froward.* to the pure You show Yourself pure, but to the devious You show Yourself shrewd.
- 27 *For thou wilt save the afflicted people; but wilt bring down high looks.* You save the humble but bring low those whose eyes are haughty.
- 28 *For thou wilt light my candle: the LORD my God will enlighten my darkness.* You, LORD, keep my lamp burning; my God turns my darkness into light.
- 29 *For by thee I have run through a troop; and by my God have I leaped over a wall.* With Your help I can advance against a troop; with my God I can scale a wall.
- 30 *As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.* As for God, His way is perfect: the LORD's word is flawless; He shields all who take refuge in Him.
- 31 *For who is God save the LORD? or who is a rock save our God?* For who is God besides the LORD? And who is the Rock except our God?
- 32 *It is God that girdeth me with strength, and maketh my way perfect.* It is God Who arms me with strength and keeps my way secure.
- 33 *He maketh my feet like hinds' feet, and setteth me upon my high places.* He makes my feet like the feet of a deer; He causes me to stand on the heights.
- 34 *He teacheth my hands to war, so that a bow of steel is broken by mine arms.* He trains my hands for battle; my arms can bend a bow of bronze.
- 35 *Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy right hand hath holden me up, and thy gentleness hath made me great.* You make Your saving help my shield, and Your right hand sustains me; Your help has made me great.
- 36 *Thou hast enlarged my steps under me, that my feet did not slip.* You provide a broad path for my feet, so that my ankles do not give way.

- 37 *I have pursued mine enemies, and overtaken them: neither did I turn again till they were consumed.* I pursued my enemies and overtook them; I did not turn back till they were destroyed.
- 38 *I have wounded them that they were not able to rise: they are fallen under my feet.* I crushed them so that they could not rise; they fell beneath my feet.
- 39 *For thou hast girded me with strength unto the battle: thou hast subdued under me those that rose up against me.* You armed me with strength for battle; You humbled my adversaries before me.
- 40 *Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies; that I might destroy them that hate me.* You made my enemies turn their backs in flight. I destroyed my foes.
- 41 *They cried, but there was none to save them: even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.* They cried for help, but there was no one to save them — to the LORD. But He did not answer.
- 42 *Then did I beat them small as the dust before the wind: I did cast them out as the dirt in the streets.* I beat them as fine as windblown dust; I trampled them like mud in the streets.
- 43 *Thou hast delivered me from the strivings of the people; and thou hast made me the head of the heathen: a people whom I have not known shall serve me.* You have delivered me from the attacks of the people; you have made me the head of nations. People I did not know now serve me,
- 44 *As soon as they hear of me, they shall obey me: the strangers shall submit themselves unto me.* foreigners cower before me; as soon as they hear of me, they obey me.
- 45 *The strangers shall fade away, and be afraid out of their close places.* They all lose heart; they come trembling from their strongholds.
- 46 *The LORD liveth; and blessed be my rock; and let the God of my salvation be exalted.* The LORD lives! Praise be to my Rock! Exalted be God my Savior!
- 47 *It is God that avengeth me, and subdueth the people under me.* He is the God Who avenges me, who subdues nations under me,

- 48 *He delivereth me from mine enemies: yea, thou liftest me up above those that rise against me: thou hast delivered me from the violent man.* who saves me from my enemies. You exalted me above my foes; from a violent man You rescued me.
- 49 *Therefore will I give thanks unto thee, O LORD, among the heathen, and sing praises unto thy name.* Therefore I will praise You, LORD, among the nations; I will sing the praises of your name.
- 50 *Great deliverance giveth he to his king; and sheweth mercy to his anointed, to David, and to his seed for evermore.* He gives his king great victories; he shows mercy to his anointed, to David and to his descendants forever.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Sam 22:1-51; Col 1:11; 1 John 4:19; Isa 12:1-6; Phil 4:13
v2 — Ps 144:2; Ps 62:7; Ps 19:14; Prov 18:10; Ps 91:2
v3 — Ps 91:15; Ps 145:3; Luke 1:71; Ps 62:8; Rom 8:31-39
v6 — Ps 50:15; 2 Sam 22:7; Ps 34:15; Ps 130:1-2; Ps 120:1
v19 — Ps 31:8; Ps 118:5; Ps 18:36; Job 36:16; Ps 40:2
v28 — 2 Sam 22:29; Job 29:3; Isa 42:16; Matt 4:16; Luke 1:79
v29 — 2 Sam 22:30; Eph 6:10-13; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Rev 3:21; Col 2:15
v30 — Deut 32:4; Prov 30:5; 2 Sam 22:31; Ps 84:11-12; Ps 12:6
v32 — Isa 45:5; 2 Cor 3:5; 2 Sam 22:33; Ps 28:7; Ps 91:2
v34 — Ps 144:1; Ps 46:9; Isa 45:1; 2 Sam 22:36; Isa 28:6
v35 — 2 Sam 22:36; Jas 3:17-18; Ps 28:7; Gal 5:22-23; 2 Cor 10:1
v39 — 2 Sam 22:40-41; Ps 18:32; Isa 45:14; 1 Cor 15:25-28; Eph 1:22

Psalm 19

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares that the heavens proclaim God's glory and the skies display His handiwork. He then celebrates the perfection of the LORD's law, which revives the soul and makes wise the simple, and prays to be kept from presumptuous sins.

- 1 *The heavens declare the glory of God; and the firmament sheweth his handywork.* The heavens declare the glory of God; the skies proclaim the work of His hands.

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| 2 <i>Day unto day uttereth speech, and
night unto night sheweth knowledge.</i> | Day after day they pour forth speech;
night after night they reveal
knowledge. |
| 3 <i>There is no speech nor language,
where their voice is not heard.</i> | They have no speech, they use no
words; no sound is heard from them. |
| 4 <i>Their line is gone out through all the
earth, and their words to the end of
the world. In them hath he set a
tabernacle for the sun,</i> | Yet their voice goes out into all the
earth, their words to the ends of the
world. In the heavens God has pitched
a tent for the sun. |
| 5 <i>Which is as a bridegroom coming out
of his chamber, and rejoiceth as a
strong man to run a race.</i> | It is like a bridegroom coming out of
His chamber, like a champion rejoicing
to run His course. |
| 6 <i>His going forth is from the end of the
heaven, and his circuit unto the ends
of it: and there is nothing hid from the
heat thereof.</i> | It rises at one end of the heavens and
makes its circuit to the other; nothing
is deprived of its warmth. |
| 7 <i>The law of the LORD is perfect,
converting the soul: the testimony of
the LORD is sure, making wise the
simple.</i> | The law of the LORD is perfect,
refreshing the soul. The statutes of the
LORD are trustworthy, making wise
the simple. |
| 8 <i>The statutes of the LORD are right,
rejoicing the heart: the commandment
of the LORD is pure, enlightening the
eyes.</i> | The precepts of the LORD are right,
giving joy to the heart. The commands
of the LORD are radiant, giving light
to the eyes. |
| 9 <i>The fear of the LORD is clean,
enduring for ever: the judgments of
the LORD are true and righteous
altogether.</i> | The fear of the LORD is pure,
enduring forever. The decrees of the
LORD are firm. All of them are
righteous. |
| 10 <i>More to be desired are they than gold,
yea, than much fine gold: sweeter also
than honey and the honeycomb.</i> | They are more precious than gold, than
much pure gold; they are sweeter than
honey, than honey from the
honeycomb. |

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| <p>11 <i>Moreover by them is thy servant warned: and in keeping of them there is great reward.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Who can understand his errors? cleanse thou me from secret faults.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Keep back thy servant also from presumptuous sins; let them not have dominion over me: then shall I be upright, and I shall be innocent from the great transgression.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Let the words of my mouth, and the meditation of my heart, be acceptable in thy sight, O LORD, my strength, and my redeemer.</i></p> | <p>By them Your servant is warned; in keeping them there is great reward.</p> <p>But who can discern their own errors? Forgive my hidden faults.</p> <p>Keep Your servant also from willful sins; may they not rule over me. Then I will be blameless, innocent of great transgression.</p> <p>May these words of my mouth and this meditation of my heart be pleasing in Your sight, LORD, my Rock and my Redeemer.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 1:19-20; Ps 8:3; Ps 50:6; Ps 148:3-4; Ps 33:6
- v2 — Ps 74:16; Ps 134:1-3; Gen 8:22; Isa 38:19; Gen 1:17-18
- v4 — Rom 10:18; Gen 1:14-18; Ps 98:3; Mal 4:2; Ps 104:2
- v5 — Phil 3:13-14; Isa 62:5
- v7 — Ps 119:130; Ps 111:7; Col 3:16; Prov 1:4; Ps 23:3
- v8 — Ps 12:6; Ps 119:105; Jer 15:16; Prov 30:5; Ps 119:92
- v9 — 1 Sam 12:24; Ps 119:142; Ps 119:137-138; Ps 34:11-14; Ps 119:1
- v10 — Ps 119:103; Ps 119:72; Ps 119:127; Prov 3:13-15; Prov 16:16
- v11 — Ps 119:11; 2 John 1:8; Prov 29:18; Heb 11:6-7; Jas 1:25
- v12 — Ps 90:8; Ps 139:23-24; Job 6:24; Jer 17:9; Ps 40:12
- v13 — Ps 119:133; Rom 6:12-14; Acts 24:16; Ps 7:10; 1 Sam 25:39
- v14 — Ps 104:34; Ps 51:15; Ps 119:108; 1 Pet 2:5; Ps 66:18-20

Psalm 20

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The people pray for the king before battle, asking the LORD to send him help from Zion and grant him victory. They declare that some trust in chariots and some in horses, but they will remember the name of the LORD their God.

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| <p>1 <i>The LORD hear thee in the day of trouble; the name of the God of Jacob defend thee;</i></p> <p>2 <i>Send thee help from the sanctuary, and strengthen thee out of Zion;</i></p> <p>3 <i>Remember all thy offerings, and accept thy burnt sacrifice; Selah.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Grant thee according to thine own heart, and fulfil all thy counsel.</i></p> <p>5 <i>We will rejoice in thy salvation, and in the name of our God we will set up our banners: the LORD fulfil all thy petitions.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Now know I that the LORD saveth his anointed; he will hear him from his holy heaven with the saving strength of his right hand.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Some trust in chariots, and some in horses: but we will remember the name of the LORD our God.</i></p> <p>8 <i>They are brought down and fallen: but we are risen, and stand upright.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Save, LORD: let the king hear us when we call.</i></p> | <p>May the LORD answer You when You are in distress; may the name of the God of Jacob protect you.</p> <p>May He send You help from the sanctuary and grant You support from Zion.</p> <p>May He remember all Your sacrifices and accept Your burnt offerings.</p> <p>May He give You the desire of Your heart and make all Your plans succeed.</p> <p>May we shout for joy over Your victory and lift up our banners in the name of our God. May the LORD grant all Your requests.</p> <p>Now this I know: the LORD gives victory to His anointed. He answers Him from His heavenly sanctuary with the victorious power of His right hand.</p> <p>Some trust in chariots and some in horses. But We trust in the name of the LORD our God.</p> <p>They are brought to their knees and fall. But We rise up and stand firm.</p> <p>LORD, give victory to the king! Answer us when we call!</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 18:10; Ps 138:7; Ps 91:14-15; Ps 46:11; Heb 5:7
- v2 — 1 Kgs 8:44-45
- v3 — Ps 51:19; 2 Chr 7:1
- v4 — Ps 145:19; Ps 37:4; Matt 21:22; Ps 21:2; John 16:23
- v5 — Ex 17:15; 1 Sam 1:17; Ps 60:4; Isa 25:9; Isa 61:10
- v6 — Ps 28:8
- v7 — Isa 31:1; Jer 17:5; Prov 21:31; Ps 33:16-17; 2 Chr 32:8

v8 — Ps 125:1; Mic 7:8

v9 — Ps 5:2; Ps 44:4; Ps 118:25-26

Psalm 21

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The king rejoices in the LORD's strength and the victories God has given him. The psalm celebrates God's blessings on the king -- life, honor, and a crown of gold -- and prophesies the destruction of all the king's enemies by the hand of the LORD.

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| 1 <i>The king shall joy in thy strength, O LORD; and in thy salvation how greatly shall he rejoice!</i> | The king rejoices in your strength, LORD. How great is His joy in the victories You give! |
| 2 <i>Thou hast given him his heart's desire, and hast not withholden the request of his lips. Selah.</i> | You have granted Him His heart's desire and have not withheld the request of His lips. |
| 3 <i>For thou preventest him with the blessings of goodness: thou settest a crown of pure gold on his head.</i> | You came to greet Him with rich blessings and placed a crown of pure gold on His head. |
| 4 <i>He asked life of thee, and thou gavest it him, even length of days for ever and ever.</i> | He asked You for life, and You gave it to Him — length of days, for ever and ever. |
| 5 <i>His glory is great in thy salvation: honour and majesty hast thou laid upon him.</i> | Through the victories You gave, His glory is great; You have bestowed on Him splendor and majesty. |
| 6 <i>For thou hast made him most blessed for ever: thou hast made him exceeding glad with thy countenance.</i> | For You have made Him most blessed forever; You have made Him exceedingly glad with Your countenance. |
| 7 <i>For the king trusteth in the LORD, and through the mercy of the most High he shall not be moved.</i> | For the king trusts in the LORD; through the mercy of the Most High He will not be shaken. |
| 8 <i>Thine hand shall find out all thine enemies: thy right hand shall find out those that hate thee.</i> | Your hand will lay hold on all Your enemies; Your right hand will seize Your foes. |

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| <p>9 <i>Thou shalt make them as a fiery oven in the time of thine anger: the LORD shall swallow them up in his wrath, and the fire shall devour them.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Their fruit shalt thou destroy from the earth, and their seed from among the children of men.</i></p> <p>11 <i>For they intended evil against thee: they imagined a mischievous device, which they are not able to perform.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Therefore shalt thou make them turn their back, when thou shalt make ready thine arrows upon thy strings against the face of them.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Be thou exalted, LORD, in thine own strength: so will we sing and praise thy power.</i></p> | <p>When You appear for battle, You will burn them up as in a blazing furnace. The LORD will swallow them up in His wrath. His fire will consume them.</p> <p>You will destroy their descendants from the earth, their posterity from mankind.</p> <p>Though they plot evil against You and devise wicked schemes, they cannot succeed.</p> <p>You will make them turn their backs when You aim at them with drawn bow.</p> <p>Be exalted in Your strength, LORD; we will sing and praise Your might.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 62:7; Ps 28:7; Matt 2:2; Heb 12:2; Ps 59:16-17
- v2 — Ps 37:4; Ps 20:4-5; Ps 2:8-9
- v3 — 2 Sam 12:30; Eph 1:3; Ps 59:10; Ps 31:19; 1 Chr 20:2
- v4 — Ps 91:16; Rev 1:18; Ps 119:77; Ps 61:5-6; Ps 133:3
- v6 — Acts 2:28; Ps 45:7; Ps 16:11; Gal 3:9; Acts 3:26
- v7 — Ps 16:8; Ps 91:2; Dan 7:14; Ps 18:2; Ps 20:7-8
- v8 — 1 Cor 15:25; Ps 110:1-2; Ps 72:9; Luke 19:27; Rev 19:15
- v9 — Mal 4:1; Ps 50:3; Ps 18:8; 2 Thess 1:8; Nah 1:6
- v10 — Ps 37:28; 1 Kgs 13:34
- v11 — Ps 10:2; Ps 2:1; Ps 31:13; Jer 11:18-19; Isa 7:6-7
- v12 — Ps 7:12-13; Ps 18:40
- v13 — Rev 16:5-7; Rev 19:1-6; Rev 15:3-4; Ps 57:11; Ps 113:5

Psalm 22

To the chief Musician upon Aijeleth Shahar. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist cries out "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" and describes pierced hands and feet, bones out of joint, and enemies casting lots for his garments -- a prophetic portrait of the crucifixion. He vows that all the ends of the earth will turn to the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? why art thou so far from helping me, and from the words of my roaring?</i> | My God, my God, why have You forsaken me? Why are You so far from helping me, and from the words of my roaring? |
| 2 | <i>O my God, I cry in the daytime, but thou hearest not; and in the night season, and am not silent.</i> | O my God, I cry in the daytime, but You hear not; and in the night season, and am not silent. |
| 3 | <i>But thou art holy, O thou that inhabitest the praises of Israel.</i> | Yet You are enthroned as the Holy One; You are the one Israel praises. |
| 4 | <i>Our fathers trusted in thee: they trusted, and thou didst deliver them.</i> | Our fathers trusted in You; they trusted, and You delivered them. |
| 5 | <i>They cried unto thee, and were delivered: they trusted in thee, and were not confounded.</i> | To You they cried out and were saved; in You they trusted and were not put to shame. |
| 6 | <i>But I am a worm, and no man; a reproach of men, and despised of the people.</i> | But I am a worm and not a man, scorned by everyone, despised by the people. |
| 7 | <i>All they that see me laugh me to scorn: they shoot out the lip, they shake the head, saying,</i> | All who see me mock me; they hurl insults, shaking their heads. |
| 8 | <i>He trusted on the LORD that he would deliver him: let him deliver him, seeing he delighted in him.</i> | "He trusts in the LORD," they say, "let the LORD rescue Him. Let Him deliver Him, since He delights in Him." |
| 9 | <i>But thou art he that took me out of the womb: thou didst make me hope when I was upon my mother's breasts.</i> | Yet You brought me out of the womb; You made me trust in You, even at my mother's breast. |
| 10 | <i>I was cast upon thee from the womb: thou art my God from my mother's belly.</i> | From birth I was cast on You; from my mother's womb You have been my God. |

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| 11 | <i>Be not far from me; for trouble is near; for there is none to help.</i> | Do not be far from me, for trouble is near and there is no one to help. |
| 12 | <i>Many bulls have compassed me: strong bulls of Bashan have beset me round.</i> | Many bulls surround me; strong bulls of Bashan encircle me. |
| 13 | <i>They gaped upon me with their mouths, as a ravening and a roaring lion.</i> | Roaring lions that tear their prey open their mouths wide against me. |
| 14 | <i>I am poured out like water, and all my bones are out of joint: my heart is like wax; it is melted in the midst of my bowels.</i> | I am poured out like water. All my bones are out of joint. My heart has turned to wax; it has melted within me. |
| 15 | <i>My strength is dried up like a potsherd; and my tongue cleaveth to my jaws; and thou hast brought me into the dust of death.</i> | My mouth is dried up like a potsherd, and my tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth; You lay me in the dust of death. |
| 16 | <i>For dogs have compassed me: the assembly of the wicked have inclosed me: they pierced my hands and my feet.</i> | Dogs surround me, a pack of villains encircles me; they pierce my hands and my feet. |
| 17 | <i>I may tell all my bones: they look and stare upon me.</i> | All my bones are on display; people stare and gloat over me. |
| 18 | <i>They part my garments among them, and cast lots upon my vesture.</i> | They divide my clothes among them and cast lots for my garment. |
| 19 | <i>But be not thou far from me, O LORD: O my strength, haste thee to help me.</i> | But You, LORD, do not be far from me. You are my strength; come quickly to help me. |
| 20 | <i>Deliver my soul from the sword; my darling from the power of the dog.</i> | Deliver me from the sword, my precious life from the power of the dogs. |
| 21 | <i>Save me from the lion's mouth: for thou hast heard me from the horns of the unicorns.</i> | Save me from the lion's mouth; for You have heard me from the horns of the unicorns. |

- 22 *I will declare thy name unto my brethren: in the midst of the congregation will I praise thee.* I will declare Your name to my people; in the assembly I will praise You.
- 23 *Ye that fear the LORD, praise him; all ye the seed of Jacob, glorify him; and fear him, all ye the seed of Israel.* You who fear the LORD, praise Him! All You descendants of Jacob, honor him! Revere him, all you descendants of Israel!
- 24 *For he hath not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; neither hath he hidden his face from him; but when he cried unto him, he heard.* For He has not despised or scorned the suffering of the afflicted one; He has not hidden His face from Him but has listened to His cry for help.
- 25 *My praise shall be of thee in the great congregation: I will pay my vows before them that fear him.* From You comes the theme of my praise in the great assembly; before those who fear You I will fulfill my vows.
- 26 *The meek shall eat and be satisfied: they shall praise the LORD that seek him: your heart shall live for ever.* The poor will eat and be satisfied; those who seek the LORD will praise Him — may Your hearts live forever!
- 27 *All the ends of the world shall remember and turn unto the LORD: and all the kindreds of the nations shall worship before thee.* All the ends of the earth will remember and turn to the LORD. All the families of the nations will bow down before him,
- 28 *For the kingdom is the LORD'S: and he is the governor among the nations.* for dominion belongs to the LORD and He rules over the nations.
- 29 *All they that be fat upon earth shall eat and worship: all they that go down to the dust shall bow before him: and none can keep alive his own soul.* All the rich of the earth will feast and worship; all who go down to the dust will kneel before Him — those who cannot keep themselves alive.
- 30 *A seed shall serve him; it shall be accounted to the Lord for a generation.* Posterity will serve Him; future generations will be told about the Lord.

- 31 *They shall come, and shall declare his righteousness unto a people that shall be born, that he hath done this.*
- They will proclaim His righteousness, declaring to a people yet unborn: He has done it!

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mark 15:34; Matt 27:46; Heb 5:7; Ps 22:16; Job 3:24
- v2 — Ps 42:3; Luke 18:7; Ps 88:1; Luke 22:41-46; Ps 55:16-17
- v3 — Ps 50:23; Deut 10:21; Isa 6:3; Rev 4:8; Ps 99:9
- v6 — Isa 53:3; Job 25:6; Isa 49:7; Isa 41:14; Ps 69:7-12
- v8 — Matt 27:42-43; Mark 15:30-32; Ps 91:14; Ps 18:19; Matt 3:17
- v9 — Ps 71:6; Isa 49:1-2; Ps 71:17; Ps 139:15-16; Matt 2:13-15
- v12 — Amos 4:1-3; Acts 4:27; Ps 68:30; Matt 27:1
- v16 — John 19:37; Zech 12:10; Matt 27:35; John 20:25; John 19:23
- v18 — Matt 27:35; Luke 23:34; Mark 15:24; John 19:23-24
- v24 — Heb 5:7; Isa 50:6-9; Ps 118:5; Ps 116:3-6; Luke 23:46
- v26 — Ps 69:32; Isa 65:13; Ps 40:16; Ps 105:3-4; John 6:48-58
- v27 — Ps 86:9; Isa 45:22; Rev 7:9-12; Ps 2:8; Isa 49:6

Psalm 23

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares the LORD is his shepherd and he shall not want. God leads him beside still waters, restores his soul, prepares a table before his enemies, and anoints his head with oil -- goodness and mercy shall follow him all the days of his life.

- 1 *The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.*
- The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.
- 2 *He maketh me to lie down in green pastures: he leadeth me beside the still waters.*
- He makes me lie down in green pastures; He leads me beside the still waters.
- 3 *He restoreth my soul: he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness for his name's sake.*
- He restores my soul; He leads me in the paths of righteousness for His name's sake.
- 4 *Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil: for thou art with me; thy rod and thy staff they comfort me.*
- Yes, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil; for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me.

5	<i>Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.</i>	You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies; You anoint my head with oil; my cup runs over.
6	<i>Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life: and I will dwell in the house of the LORD for ever.</i>	Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Phil 4:19; John 10:11; Isa 40:11; John 10:27-30; John 10:14
- v2 — Rev 7:17; Rev 22:1; Ezek 34:13-14; Ps 46:4; Rev 21:6
- v3 — Isa 42:16; Ps 31:3; Ps 19:7; Ps 51:10; Ps 143:8-10
- v4 — Isa 41:10; Ps 118:6; Ps 138:7; Isa 43:1-2; Ps 3:6
- v5 — Eph 3:20; Ps 92:10; Ps 45:7; Ps 16:5; 1 John 2:20
- v6 — Ps 27:4; 2 Tim 4:18; 2 Cor 5:1; Ps 36:7-10; Ps 16:11

Psalm 24

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares that the earth is the LORD's and all that is in it. He asks who may ascend the hill of the LORD and answers: the one with clean hands and a pure heart. The psalm calls for the everlasting doors to be lifted up so the King of glory may come in.

1	<i>The earth is the LORD'S, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.</i>	The earth is the LORD's, and everything in it, the world. All who live in it;
2	<i>For he hath founded it upon the seas, and established it upon the floods.</i>	for He founded it on the seas and established it on the waters.
3	<i>Who shall ascend into the hill of the LORD? or who shall stand in his holy place?</i>	Who may ascend the mountain of the LORD? Who may stand in His holy place?
4	<i>He that hath clean hands, and a pure heart; who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity, nor sworn deceitfully.</i>	The one who has clean hands and a pure heart, who does not trust in an idol or swear by a false god.

5	<i>He shall receive the blessing from the LORD, and righteousness from the God of his salvation.</i>	They will receive blessing from the LORD and vindication from God their Savior.
6	<i>This is the generation of them that seek him, that seek thy face, O Jacob. Selah.</i>	Such is the generation of those who seek Him, who seek your face, God of Jacob.
7	<i>Lift up your heads, O ye gates; and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.</i>	Lift up Your heads, You gates; be lifted up, You ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.
8	<i>Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, the LORD mighty in battle.</i>	Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, the LORD mighty in battle.
9	<i>Lift up your heads, O ye gates; even lift them up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.</i>	Lift up Your heads, You gates; lift them up, You ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.
10	<i>Who is this King of glory? The LORD of hosts, he is the King of glory. Selah.</i>	Who is He, this King of glory? The LORD of hosts — He is the King of glory. Selah.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 89:11; 1 Cor 10:26; 1 Chr 29:11; Job 41:11; Deut 10:14
- v2 — Jer 5:22; Gen 1:9-10; Ps 136:6; Ps 104:5-6; Job 38:4
- v3 — Ps 15:1; Heb 12:28; Ps 2:6; Ps 65:4; Mal 3:1
- v4 — Matt 5:8; Ps 51:10; Jas 4:8; Job 17:9; Ps 73:1
- v5 — Phil 3:9; Eph 1:3; Titus 3:4-6; 1 Pet 3:9; Isa 12:2
- v6 — Ps 105:4; Ps 27:8
- v7 — Isa 26:2; Ps 118:19-20; Rev 4:11; Ps 97:6; 1 Cor 2:8
- v8 — Ex 15:3; Rev 19:11-21; Rev 6:2; Col 2:15; Ps 45:3-6
- v10 — Titus 2:13; Matt 25:34; Isa 54:5; Matt 25:31; John 12:40

Psalm 25

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist lifts his soul to the LORD and asks to be taught God's paths and led in truth. He pleads for mercy, forgiveness, and deliverance, confessing his loneliness and affliction and

trusting that the LORD will redeem Israel out of all his troubles.

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| 1 | <i>Unto thee, O LORD, do I lift up my soul.</i> | To You, LORD, I lift up my soul. |
| 2 | <i>O my God, I trust in thee: let me not be ashamed, let not mine enemies triumph over me.</i> | I trust in You; do not let me be put to shame, nor let my enemies triumph over me. |
| 3 | <i>Yea, let none that wait on thee be ashamed: let them be ashamed which transgress without cause.</i> | No one who hopes in you will ever be put to shame, but shame will come on those who are treacherous without cause. |
| 4 | <i>Shew me thy ways, O LORD; teach me thy paths.</i> | Show me Your ways, LORD, teach me Your paths. |
| 5 | <i>Lead me in thy truth, and teach me: for thou art the God of my salvation; on thee do I wait all the day.</i> | Guide me in Your truth and teach me, for You are God my Savior, and my hope is in You all day long. |
| 6 | <i>Remember, O LORD, thy tender mercies and thy lovingkindnesses; for they have been ever of old.</i> | Remember, LORD, Your tender mercies and Your lovingkindnesses, for they have been ever of old. |
| 7 | <i>Remember not the sins of my youth, nor my transgressions: according to thy mercy remember thou me for thy goodness' sake, O LORD.</i> | Do not remember the sins of my youth or my transgressions; according to Your mercy remember me, for Your goodness' sake, O LORD. |
| 8 | <i>Good and upright is the LORD: therefore will he teach sinners in the way.</i> | Good and upright is the LORD; therefore He instructs sinners in His ways. |
| 9 | <i>The meek will he guide in judgment: and the meek will he teach his way.</i> | He guides the humble in what is right and teaches them His way. |
| 10 | <i>All the paths of the LORD are mercy and truth unto such as keep his covenant and his testimonies.</i> | All the paths of the LORD are mercy and truth to such as keep His covenant and His testimonies. |
| 11 | <i>For thy name's sake, O LORD, pardon mine iniquity; for it is great.</i> | For the sake of Your name, LORD, forgive my iniquity, though it is great. |

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| 12 <i>What man is he that feareth the LORD? him shall he teach in the way that he shall choose.</i> | Who, then, are those who fear the LORD? He will instruct them in the ways they should choose. |
| 13 <i>His soul shall dwell at ease; and his seed shall inherit the earth.</i> | They will spend their days in prosperity. Their descendants will inherit the land. |
| 14 <i>The secret of the LORD is with them that fear him; and he will shew them his covenant.</i> | The LORD confides in those who fear Him; He makes His covenant known to them. |
| 15 <i>Mine eyes are ever toward the LORD; for he shall pluck my feet out of the net.</i> | My eyes are ever on the LORD, for only He will release my feet from the snare. |
| 16 <i>Turn thee unto me, and have mercy upon me; for I am desolate and afflicted.</i> | Turn to me and be gracious to me, for I am lonely and afflicted. |
| 17 <i>The troubles of my heart are enlarged: O bring thou me out of my distresses.</i> | Relieve the troubles of my heart and free me from my anguish. |
| 18 <i>Look upon mine affliction and my pain; and forgive all my sins.</i> | Look on my affliction and my distress and take away all my sins. |
| 19 <i>Consider mine enemies; for they are many; and they hate me with cruel hatred.</i> | See how numerous are my enemies and how fiercely they hate me! |
| 20 <i>O keep my soul, and deliver me: let me not be ashamed; for I put my trust in thee.</i> | Guard my life and rescue me; do not let me be put to shame, for I take refuge in You. |
| 21 <i>Let integrity and uprightness preserve me; for I wait on thee.</i> | May integrity and uprightness protect me, because my hope, LORD, is in You. |
| 22 <i>Redeem Israel, O God, out of all his troubles.</i> | Deliver Israel, O God, from all their troubles! |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-eh-nant) — A binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. When God makes a covenant, He binds Himself to keep it — it is not a negotiation but a divine guarantee.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 143:8; Ps 86:4; Ps 24:4; 1 Sam 1:15; Lam 3:41
- v2 — Rom 10:11; Ps 41:11; Ps 71:1; Ps 22:5; Rom 5:5
- v3 — Lam 3:25; Isa 40:31; Isa 49:23; Mic 7:7; Ps 62:5
- v4 — Ps 86:11; Ps 143:8; Ps 27:11; Ps 119:27; Ex 33:13
- v5 — Prov 8:34; Isa 30:18; Ps 25:10; John 14:26; Ps 43:3-4
- v8 — Jas 1:5; Eph 1:17-18; Ps 32:8; John 6:44-45; Ps 92:15
- v9 — Prov 3:5-6; Ps 23:3; Matt 5:5; John 14:6; Gal 5:23
- v10 — Jas 5:11; Rom 8:28; Heb 8:8-12; Ps 40:11; John 1:17
- v12 — Ps 37:23; Ps 32:8; John 7:17; Ps 111:10; Eccl 12:13
- v14 — John 15:15; John 14:21-23; John 7:17; Eph 1:9; 1 Cor 2:14
- v15 — Ps 141:8; Ps 124:7-8; Ps 31:4; Ps 121:1-2; Ps 123:2
- v21 — Prov 11:3; Ps 41:12; Ps 26:1; Ps 26:11; Prov 20:7

Psalm 26

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist asks the LORD to judge him, declaring that he has walked in integrity and has not sat with vain persons or dissemblers. He loves the habitation of God's house and asks to be gathered not with sinners but redeemed by mercy.

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| 1 | <i>Judge me, O LORD; for I have walked in mine integrity: I have trusted also in the LORD; therefore I shall not slide.</i> | Vindicate me, LORD, for I have led a blameless life; I have trusted in the LORD and have not faltered. |
| 2 | <i>Examine me, O LORD, and prove me; try my reins and my heart.</i> | Test me, LORD, and try me, examine my heart and my mind; |
| 3 | <i>For thy lovingkindness is before mine eyes: and I have walked in thy truth.</i> | for I have always been mindful of Your mercy and have lived in reliance on Your faithfulness. |
| 4 | <i>I have not sat with vain persons, neither will I go in with dissemblers.</i> | I do not sit with the deceitful, nor do I associate with hypocrites. |
| 5 | <i>I have hated the congregation of evil doers; and will not sit with the wicked.</i> | I abhor the assembly of evildoers and refuse to sit with the wicked. |

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| <p>6 <i>I will wash mine hands in innocency: so will I compass thine altar, O LORD:</i></p> <p>7 <i>That I may publish with the voice of thanksgiving, and tell of all thy wondrous works.</i></p> <p>8 <i>LORD, I have loved the habitation of thy house, and the place where thine honour dwelleth.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Gather not my soul with sinners, nor my life with bloody men:</i></p> <p>10 <i>In whose hands is mischief, and their right hand is full of bribes.</i></p> <p>11 <i>But as for me, I will walk in mine integrity: redeem me, and be merciful unto me.</i></p> <p>12 <i>My foot standeth in an even place: in the congregations will I bless the LORD.</i></p> | <p>I wash my hands in innocence, and go about Your altar, LORD,</p> <p>proclaiming aloud Your praise and telling of all Your wonderful deeds.</p> <p>LORD, I love the house where You live, the place where Your glory dwells.</p> <p>Do not take away my soul along with sinners, my life with those who are bloodthirsty,</p> <p>in whose hands are wicked schemes, whose right hands are full of bribes.</p> <p>I lead a blameless life; deliver me and be merciful to me.</p> <p>My feet stand on level ground; in the great assembly I will praise the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 28:7; Ps 7:8; Prov 20:7; 1 Sam 24:15; 2 Kgs 20:3
- v2 — Ps 139:23-24; Ps 7:9; Ps 17:3; Zech 13:9
- v3 — 1 John 1:7; 2 Kgs 20:3
- v4 — Jer 15:17; Ps 1:1; Prov 13:20; 2 Cor 6:17; Ps 119:115
- v5 — Ps 31:6; Ps 101:3-8; Ps 139:21-22
- v6 — Ps 73:13; Isa 1:16-18
- v7 — Ps 9:1; Ps 71:17-19
- v8 — Ps 84:10; Ps 27:4-6; John 2:14-17; Ps 122:9; Ps 84:1-2
- v12 — Ps 27:11; Ps 40:2; Ps 111:1; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 22:22-25

Psalm 27

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares the LORD is his light and salvation and asks whom he shall fear. He desires one thing above all -- to dwell in the house of the LORD forever. Though father and mother forsake him, the LORD will take him up, and he resolves to wait on the LORD and be of good courage.

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| 1 | <i>The LORD is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the LORD is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?</i> | The LORD is my light and my salvation — whom shall I fear? The LORD is the stronghold of my life — of whom shall I be afraid? |
| 2 | <i>When the wicked, even mine enemies and my foes, came upon me to eat up my flesh, they stumbled and fell.</i> | When the wicked advance against me to devour me, it is my enemies and my foes who will stumble and fall. |
| 3 | <i>Though an host should encamp against me, my heart shall not fear: though war should rise against me, in this will I be confident.</i> | Though an army besiege me, my heart will not fear; though war break out against me, even then I will be confident. |
| 4 | <i>One thing have I desired of the LORD, that will I seek after; that I may dwell in the house of the LORD all the days of my life, to behold the beauty of the LORD, and to enquire in his temple.</i> | One thing I ask from the LORD, this only do I seek: that I may dwell in the house of the LORD all the days of my life, to gaze on the beauty of the LORD and to seek Him in His temple. |
| 5 | <i>For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock.</i> | For in the day of trouble He will keep me safe in His dwelling; He will hide me in the shelter of His sacred tent and set me high upon a rock. |
| 6 | <i>And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me: therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy; I will sing, yea, I will sing praises unto the LORD.</i> | Then my head will be exalted above the enemies who surround me; at His sacred tent I will sacrifice with shouts of joy; I will sing and make music to the LORD. |
| 7 | <i>Hear, O LORD, when I cry with my voice: have mercy also upon me, and answer me.</i> | Hear my voice when I call, LORD; be merciful to me and answer me. |

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| 8 | <i>When thou saidst, Seek ye my face; my heart said unto thee, Thy face, LORD, will I seek.</i> | My heart says of You, "Seek His face!" Your face, LORD, I will seek. |
| 9 | <i>Hide not thy face far from me; put not thy servant away in anger: thou hast been my help; leave me not, neither forsake me, O God of my salvation.</i> | Do not hide Your face from me, do not turn Your servant away in anger; You have been my help. Do not reject me or forsake me, God my Savior. |
| 10 | <i>When my father and my mother forsake me, then the LORD will take me up.</i> | Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me. |
| 11 | <i>Teach me thy way, O LORD, and lead me in a plain path, because of mine enemies.</i> | Teach me Your way, LORD; lead me in a straight path because of my oppressors. |
| 12 | <i>Deliver me not over unto the will of mine enemies: for false witnesses are risen up against me, and such as breathe out cruelty.</i> | Do not turn me over to the desire of my foes, for false witnesses rise up against me, spouting malicious accusations. |
| 13 | <i>I had fainted, unless I had believed to see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living.</i> | I remain confident of this: I will see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living. |
| 14 | <i>Wait on the LORD: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart: wait, I say, on the LORD.</i> | Wait for the LORD; be strong and take heart and wait for the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Heb 13:6; Ps 118:6; Ex 15:2; 2 Cor 12:9; Ps 84:11
v3 — Ps 3:6; 1 Pet 3:14; Rom 8:35-37; Phil 1:28; 2 Cor 5:6-8
v4 — Ps 26:8; Ps 23:6; Ps 65:4; Ps 84:4; Ps 84:10
v5 — Prov 18:10; Ps 31:20; Ps 138:7; Ps 91:1; Ps 50:15
v6 — Ps 3:3; Heb 13:15; 2 Sam 22:49; Ps 107:22; Isa 12:6
v8 — Ps 105:4; Jer 29:12-13; Isa 55:6-7; Ps 119:58; Ps 24:6
v9 — Ps 69:17; Ps 143:7; Ps 102:2; Isa 46:3-4; Heb 13:5
v10 — Isa 49:15; Isa 40:11; John 16:32; Matt 10:36; 2 Tim 4:16
v11 — Ps 25:4-5; Ps 5:8; Ps 86:11; Ps 26:12; Ps 143:8-10
v12 — Matt 26:59-60; Ps 31:8; Ps 41:11; Acts 6:11-13; Ps 35:11

v13 — 2 Cor 4:16; Ps 142:5; 2 Cor 4:8-14; Ps 56:3; Ps 31:19

v14 — Isa 40:31; Ps 31:24; Isa 30:18; Ps 37:34; Ps 130:5

Psalm 28

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist cries to the LORD his rock, pleading not to be drawn away with the wicked who speak peace to their neighbors but have mischief in their hearts. He blesses the LORD who has heard his supplications and become his strength and shield.

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| <p>1 <i>Unto thee will I cry, O LORD my rock; be not silent to me: lest, if thou be silent to me, I become like them that go down into the pit.</i></p> | <p>To You, LORD, I call; You are my Rock, do not turn a deaf ear to me. For if You remain silent, I will be like those who go down to the pit.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Hear the voice of my supplications, when I cry unto thee, when I lift up my hands toward thy holy oracle.</i></p> | <p>Hear the voice of my supplications when I cry to You, when I lift up my hands toward Your holy oracle.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Draw me not away with the wicked, and with the workers of iniquity, which speak peace to their neighbours, but mischief is in their hearts.</i></p> | <p>Do not drag me away with the wicked, with those who do evil, who speak cordially with their neighbors but harbor malice in their hearts.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Give them according to their deeds, and according to the wickedness of their endeavours: give them after the work of their hands; render to them their desert.</i></p> | <p>Repay them for their deeds and for their evil work; repay them for what their hands have done and bring back on them what they deserve.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Because they regard not the works of the LORD, nor the operation of his hands, he shall destroy them, and not build them up.</i></p> | <p>Because they have no regard for the deeds of the LORD and what His hands have done, He will tear them down and never build them up again.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Blessed be the LORD, because he hath heard the voice of my supplications.</i></p> | <p>Praise be to the LORD, for He has heard my cry for mercy.</p> |

7	<i>The LORD is my strength and my shield; my heart trusted in him, and I am helped: therefore my heart greatly rejoiceth; and with my song will I praise him.</i>	The LORD is my strength and my shield; my heart trusts in Him. He helps me. My heart leaps for joy, and with my song I praise Him.
8	<i>The LORD is their strength, and he is the saving strength of his anointed.</i>	The LORD is their strength, and He is the saving strength of His anointed.
9	<i>Save thy people, and bless thine inheritance: feed them also, and lift them up for ever.</i>	Save Your people and bless Your inheritance; be their shepherd and carry them forever.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 143:7; Ps 18:2; Ps 88:4-6; Ps 83:1; Prov 1:12
- v2 — Ps 141:2; Ps 138:2; Ps 140:6; 1 Tim 2:8
- v3 — Ps 55:21; Ps 12:2; Jer 9:8-9; Ps 26:9; Mic 3:5
- v4 — 2 Tim 4:14; Rev 22:12; Rev 18:6; Ps 109:17-21
- v5 — Isa 5:12; Rom 1:28; Job 34:26-27; John 12:37; Ps 92:4-6
- v6 — Ps 31:21-22; Ps 107:19-22; Ps 118:5; Ps 116:1-2; Ps 69:33-34
- v7 — Ps 30:11-12; Ps 56:3-4; Eph 6:10; Isa 61:10; Isa 12:2
- v8 — Ps 20:6; Ps 140:7; Isa 61:1; 1 Sam 16:13
- v9 — Isa 40:11; Ps 78:71; Deut 9:29; Isa 63:9; Eph 1:18

Psalm 29

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist calls the mighty to give the LORD glory and strength. The voice of the LORD thunders over the waters, breaks the cedars of Lebanon, shakes the wilderness, and strips the forests bare -- and in His temple everything declares His glory.

1	<i>Give unto the LORD, O ye mighty, give unto the LORD glory and strength.</i>	Give to the LORD, O You mighty, give to the LORD glory and strength.
2	<i>Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name; worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.</i>	Give to the LORD the glory due to His name; worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.

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| <p>3 <i>The voice of the LORD is upon the waters: the God of glory thundereth: the LORD is upon many waters.</i></p> <p>4 <i>The voice of the LORD is powerful; the voice of the LORD is full of majesty.</i></p> <p>5 <i>The voice of the LORD breaketh the cedars; yea, the LORD breaketh the cedars of Lebanon.</i></p> <p>6 <i>He maketh them also to skip like a calf; Lebanon and Sirion like a young unicorn.</i></p> <p>7 <i>The voice of the LORD divideth the flames of fire.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The voice of the LORD shaketh the wilderness; the LORD shaketh the wilderness of Kadesh.</i></p> <p>9 <i>The voice of the LORD maketh the hinds to calve, and discovereth the forests: and in his temple doth every one speak of his glory.</i></p> <p>10 <i>The LORD sitteth upon the flood; yea, the LORD sitteth King for ever.</i></p> <p>11 <i>The LORD will give strength unto his people; the LORD will bless his people with peace.</i></p> | <p>The voice of the LORD is over the waters; the God of glory thunders, the LORD thunders over the mighty waters.</p> <p>The voice of the LORD is powerful; the voice of the LORD is majestic.</p> <p>The voice of the LORD breaks the cedars; the LORD breaks in pieces the cedars of Lebanon.</p> <p>He makes them also to skip like a calf; Lebanon and Sirion like a young unicorn.</p> <p>The voice of the LORD strikes with flashes of lightning.</p> <p>The voice of the LORD shakes the desert; the LORD shakes the Desert of Kadesh.</p> <p>The voice of the LORD twists the oaks and strips the forests bare. And in His temple all cry, "Glory!"</p> <p>The LORD sits enthroned over the flood; the LORD is enthroned as King forever.</p> <p>The LORD gives strength to His people; the LORD blesses His people with peace.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 96:7-9; Rev 5:11-14; Jer 13:16-18; Ps 68:31-34; 1 Chr 16:28-29
- v2 — Ps 96:8-9; 1 Chr 16:28-29; Ps 110:3; 2 Chr 20:21; Ps 27:4
- v3 — Job 37:2-5; Ps 93:3-4; Ex 9:33; Ex 9:28; Ps 18:13-15

v4 — Ezek 10:5; Ps 33:9; Ps 68:33; Jer 51:15-16; Luke 4:36

v7 — Ps 77:18

v8 — Num 13:26

v9 — Ps 46:2-5; Ps 48:9; Ps 26:8; Job 39:1-3; Ezek 20:46-48

v10 — Ps 10:16; 1 Tim 1:17; Gen 6:17; Mark 4:41

v11 — Isa 40:31; Num 6:24-27; 2 Thess 3:16; Isa 41:10; John 16:33

Psalm 30

A Psalm and Song at the dedication of the house of David.

The psalmist praises the LORD for lifting him from the depths and healing him. He testifies that God's anger lasts a moment but His favor lasts a lifetime: weeping may endure for a night, but joy comes in the morning.

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| <p>1 <i>I will extol thee, O LORD; for thou hast lifted me up, and hast not made my foes to rejoice over me.</i></p> | <p>I will exalt You, LORD, for You lifted me out of the depths and did not let my enemies gloat over me.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>O LORD my God, I cried unto thee, and thou hast healed me.</i></p> | <p>LORD my God, I called to You for help, and You healed me.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>O LORD, thou hast brought up my soul from the grave: thou hast kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit.</i></p> | <p>LORD, You have brought up my soul from the grave; You have kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Sing unto the LORD, O ye saints of his, and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.</i></p> | <p>Sing to the LORD, O You saints of His, and give thanks at the remembrance of His holiness.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For his anger endureth but a moment; in his favour is life: weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning.</i></p> | <p>For His anger lasts only a moment. But His favor lasts a lifetime; weeping may stay for the night, but rejoicing comes in the morning.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And in my prosperity I said, I shall never be moved.</i></p> | <p>When I felt secure, I said, "I will never be shaken."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>LORD, by thy favour thou hast made my mountain to stand strong: thou didst hide thy face, and I was troubled.</i></p> | <p>LORD, when You favored me, You made my royal mountain stand firm; but when You hid Your face, I was dismayed.</p> |

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| 8 | <i>I cried to thee, O LORD; and unto the LORD I made supplication.</i> | To You, LORD, I called; to the Lord I cried for mercy: |
| 9 | <i>What profit is there in my blood, when I go down to the pit? Shall the dust praise thee? shall it declare thy truth?</i> | "What is gained if I am silenced, if I go down to the pit? Will the dust praise You? Will it proclaim Your faithfulness? |
| 10 | <i>Hear, O LORD, and have mercy upon me: LORD, be thou my helper.</i> | Hear, LORD, and be merciful to me; LORD, be my help." |
| 11 | <i>Thou hast turned for me my mourning into dancing: thou hast put off my sackcloth, and girded me with gladness;</i> | You turned my wailing into dancing; You removed my sackcloth and clothed me with joy, |
| 12 | <i>To the end that my glory may sing praise to thee, and not be silent. O LORD my God, I will give thanks unto thee for ever.</i> | that my heart may sing Your praises and not be silent. LORD my God, I will praise You forever. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 25:2; Dan 4:37; Ps 35:19; Ps 27:6; 2 Sam 5:11
v2 — Ps 103:3-4; 2 Kgs 20:5; Ps 6:2; Ps 147:3; Ex 15:26
v3 — Ps 16:10; Ps 86:13
v4 — Ps 97:12
v5 — Isa 54:7-8; 2 Cor 4:17; Ps 126:5-6; Matt 5:4; John 16:20-22
v6 — 2 Cor 12:7; Ps 119:117; Luke 12:19
v7 — Ps 104:29; Ps 143:7
v8 — Phil 4:6-7; Ps 34:6
v9 — Ps 6:5; Isa 38:18; Ps 115:17-18; Ps 118:17; Ps 88:10-12
v10 — Ps 54:4; Ps 143:1; Ps 143:7-9; Ps 28:7
v11 — Jer 31:4; Eccl 3:4; Jer 31:13-14; Isa 25:8; 2 Chr 20:12
v12 — Ps 145:2

Psalm 31

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist takes refuge in the LORD and commits his spirit into God's hands. He describes being forgotten like a dead man out of mind while enemies conspire against him, yet he trusts

in the LORD's goodness and urges all the saints to love God and be of good courage.

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| 1 | <i>In thee, O LORD, do I put my trust; let me never be ashamed: deliver me in thy righteousness.</i> | In You, LORD, I have taken refuge; let me never be put to shame; deliver me in Your righteousness. |
| 2 | <i>Bow down thine ear to me; deliver me speedily: be thou my strong rock, for an house of defence to save me.</i> | Turn Your ear to me, come quickly to my rescue; be my rock of refuge, a strong fortress to save me. |
| 3 | <i>For thou art my rock and my fortress; therefore for thy name's sake lead me, and guide me.</i> | Since You are my rock and my fortress, for the sake of Your name lead and guide me. |
| 4 | <i>Pull me out of the net that they have laid privily for me: for thou art my strength.</i> | Keep me free from the trap that is set for me, for You are my refuge. |
| 5 | <i>Into thine hand I commit my spirit: thou hast redeemed me, O LORD God of truth.</i> | Into Your hands I commit my spirit; deliver me, LORD, my faithful God. |
| 6 | <i>I have hated them that regard lying vanities: but I trust in the LORD.</i> | I hate those who cling to worthless idols; as for me, I trust in the LORD. |
| 7 | <i>I will be glad and rejoice in thy mercy: for thou hast considered my trouble; thou hast known my soul in adversities;</i> | I will be glad and rejoice in Your mercy, for You have considered my trouble; You have known my soul in adversities. |
| 8 | <i>And hast not shut me up into the hand of the enemy: thou hast set my feet in a large room.</i> | You have not given me into the hands of the enemy but have set my feet in a spacious place. |
| 9 | <i>Have mercy upon me, O LORD, for I am in trouble: mine eye is consumed with grief, yea, my soul and my belly.</i> | Be merciful to me, LORD, for I am in distress; my eyes grow weak with sorrow, my soul and body with grief. |
| 10 | <i>For my life is spent with grief, and my years with sighing: my strength faileth because of mine iniquity, and my bones are consumed.</i> | My life is consumed by anguish and my years by groaning; my strength fails because of my affliction, and my bones grow weak. |

- 11 *I was a reproach among all mine enemies, but especially among my neighbours, and a fear to mine acquaintance: they that did see me without fled from me.* Because of all my enemies, I am the utter contempt of my neighbors and an object of dread to my closest friends — those who see me on the street flee from me.
- 12 *I am forgotten as a dead man out of mind: I am like a broken vessel.* I am forgotten as though I were dead; I have become like broken pottery.
- 13 *For I have heard the slander of many: fear was on every side: while they took counsel together against me, they devised to take away my life.* For I hear many whispering, "Terror on every side!" They conspire against me and plot to take my life.
- 14 *But I trusted in thee, O LORD: I said, Thou art my God.* But I trust in You, LORD; I say, "You are my God."
- 15 *My times are in thy hand: deliver me from the hand of mine enemies, and from them that persecute me.* My times are in Your hands; deliver me from the hands of my enemies, from those who pursue me.
- 16 *Make thy face to shine upon thy servant: save me for thy mercies' sake.* Let Your face shine on Your servant; save me in Your mercy.
- 17 *Let me not be ashamed, O LORD; for I have called upon thee: let the wicked be ashamed, and let them be silent in the grave.* Let me not be ashamed, LORD, for I have called on You; let the wicked be ashamed, and let them be silent in the grave.
- 18 *Let the lying lips be put to silence; which speak grievous things proudly and contemptuously against the righteous.* Let their lying lips be silenced, for with pride and contempt they speak arrogantly against the righteous.
- 19 *Oh how great is thy goodness, which thou hast laid up for them that fear thee; which thou hast wrought for them that trust in thee before the sons of men!* How abundant are the good things that You have stored up for those who fear You, that You bestow in the sight of all, on those who take refuge in You.

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| <p>20 <i>Thou shalt hide them in the secret of thy presence from the pride of man: thou shalt keep them secretly in a pavilion from the strife of tongues.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Blessed be the LORD: for he hath shewed me his marvellous kindness in a strong city.</i></p> <p>22 <i>For I said in my haste, I am cut off from before thine eyes: nevertheless thou heardest the voice of my supplications when I cried unto thee.</i></p> <p>23 <i>O love the LORD, all ye his saints: for the LORD preserveth the faithful, and plentifully rewardeth the proud doer.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Be of good courage, and he shall strengthen your heart, all ye that hope in the LORD.</i></p> | <p>You shall hide them in the secret of Your presence from the pride of man; You shall keep them secretly in a pavilion from the strife of tongues.</p> <p>Blessed be the LORD, for He has shown me His marvellous kindness in a strong city.</p> <p>In my alarm I said, "I am cut off from Your sight!" Yet You heard my cry for mercy when I called to You for help.</p> <p>O love the LORD, all You His saints! For the LORD preserves the faithful, and plentifully rewards the proud doer.</p> <p>Be strong and take heart, all You who hope in the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 10:11; Ps 25:2; Ps 71:1-3; Ps 22:4-5; Ps 143:1
- v5 — Luke 23:46; Acts 7:59; Deut 32:4; Ps 71:23; 1 Pet 1:18-19
- v7 — Isa 49:13; Isa 63:9; Ps 119:153; 2 Tim 2:19; John 10:27-30
- v8 — Job 36:16; Ps 4:1; Deut 32:30; Ps 18:19; 1 Sam 24:18
- v14 — Ps 56:3-4; Ps 18:2; Ps 43:5; Ps 16:1-2; Matt 26:42
- v15 — Acts 1:7; John 17:1; Eccl 3:1-8; John 7:6; Ps 142:6
- v16 — Ps 4:6; Ps 6:4; Ps 80:3; Dan 9:9; Rom 9:15
- v19 — 1 Cor 2:9; Isa 64:4; Lam 3:23-25; 1 Pet 1:4-5; Col 3:2-4
- v20 — Ps 27:5; Ps 32:7; Ps 91:1-4; Job 5:21; Ps 64:2-4
- v22 — Ps 116:11; Heb 5:7; Ezek 37:11; Job 35:14; Ps 88:16
- v23 — Ps 97:10; Ps 94:2; Ps 145:20; John 10:27-30; Ps 34:9
- v24 — Ps 27:14; Ps 146:5; Col 1:11; Isa 35:3-4; Heb 12:12-13

Psalm 32

A Psalm of David. Maschil.

The psalmist declares blessed the man whose transgression is forgiven and whose sin is covered. He confesses that when he kept silent his bones wasted away, but when he acknowledged his sin the LORD forgave the iniquity of his heart. He calls the righteous to rejoice and shout for joy.

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| <p>1 <i>Blessed is he whose transgression is forgiven, whose sin is covered.</i></p> | <p>Blessed is the one whose transgressions are forgiven, whose sins are covered.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

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| <p>2 <i>Blessed is the man unto whom the LORD imputeth not iniquity, and in whose spirit there is no guile.</i></p> | <p>Blessed is the one whose sin the LORD does not count against them and in whose spirit is no deceit.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>When I kept silence, my bones waxed old through my roaring all the day long.</i></p> | <p>When I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For day and night thy hand was heavy upon me: my moisture is turned into the drought of summer. Selah.</i></p> | <p>For day and night Your hand was heavy on me; my strength was sapped as in the heat of summer.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>I acknowledged my sin unto thee, and mine iniquity have I not hid. I said, I will confess my transgressions unto the LORD; and thou forgavest the iniquity of my sin. Selah.</i></p> | <p>Then I acknowledged my sin to You and did not cover up my iniquity. I said, "I will confess my transgressions to the LORD." And You forgave the guilt of my sin.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For this shall every one that is godly pray unto thee in a time when thou mayest be found: surely in the floods of great waters they shall not come nigh unto him.</i></p> | <p>Therefore let all the faithful pray to You while You may be found; surely the rising of the mighty waters will not reach them.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Thou art my hiding place; thou shalt preserve me from trouble; thou shalt compass me about with songs of deliverance. Selah.</i></p> | <p>You are my hiding place; You will protect me from trouble and surround me with songs of deliverance.</p> |

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| 8 | <i>I will instruct thee and teach thee in the way which thou shalt go: I will guide thee with mine eye.</i> | I will instruct You and teach You in the way You should go; I will counsel You with my loving eye on You. |
| 9 | <i>Be ye not as the horse, or as the mule, which have no understanding; whose mouth must be held in with bit and bridle, lest they come near unto thee.</i> | Do not be like the horse or the mule, which have no understanding but must be controlled by bit and bridle or they will not come to You. |
| 10 | <i>Many sorrows shall be to the wicked: but he that trusteth in the LORD, mercy shall compass him about.</i> | Many are the woes of the wicked. But The LORD's mercy surrounds the one who trusts in him. |
| 11 | <i>Be glad in the LORD, and rejoice, ye righteous: and shout for joy, all ye that are upright in heart.</i> | Rejoice in the LORD and be glad, You righteous; sing, all You who are upright in heart! |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 4:6-8; Isa 44:22; Ps 85:2; Acts 13:38-39; Isa 43:25
v3 — Prov 28:13; Ps 38:8; Ps 38:3; Ps 22:1; Lam 3:8
v4 — Ps 38:2-8; 1 Sam 5:11; Job 33:7; Ps 39:10-11
v5 — Prov 28:13; 2 Sam 12:13; Ps 51:3-5; Ps 38:18; Ps 30:5
v6 — Isa 55:6; Isa 43:2; 2 Cor 6:2; Prov 1:28; Ps 4:3
v7 — Ps 91:1; Ps 119:114; Ps 27:5; Ps 9:9; Ps 143:9
v8 — Prov 3:5-6; Ps 33:18; Ps 25:8-10; Matt 11:29; Prov 8:10-11
v9 — Prov 26:3; Jer 4:22; Jer 8:6-7; Job 35:11; Jas 4:7-10
v10 — Prov 16:20; Isa 12:2-3; Prov 13:21; Ps 147:11; Rom 2:8-9
v11 — Ps 64:10; Phil 4:4; Ps 97:12; Ps 5:11

Psalm 33

The psalmist calls the righteous to praise the LORD with harp and new song. He celebrates God's word that made the heavens, His sovereignty that overrules the counsel of nations, and His watchful eye over those who fear Him and hope in His mercy.

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| 1 | <i>Rejoice in the LORD, O ye righteous: for praise is comely for the upright.</i> | Sing joyfully to the LORD, You righteous; it is fitting for the upright to praise Him. |
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| 2 | <i>Praise the LORD with harp: sing unto him with the psaltery and an instrument of ten strings.</i> | Praise the LORD with the harp; make music to Him on the ten-stringed lyre. |
| 3 | <i>Sing unto him a new song; play skilfully with a loud noise.</i> | Sing to Him a new song; play skillfully, and shout for joy. |
| 4 | <i>For the word of the LORD is right; and all his works are done in truth.</i> | For the word of the LORD is right and true; He is faithful in all He does. |
| 5 | <i>He loveth righteousness and judgment: the earth is full of the goodness of the LORD.</i> | He loves righteousness and judgment; the earth is full of the goodness of the LORD. |
| 6 | <i>By the word of the LORD were the heavens made; and all the host of them by the breath of his mouth.</i> | By the word of the LORD the heavens were made, their starry host by the breath of His mouth. |
| 7 | <i>He gathereth the waters of the sea together as an heap: he layeth up the depth in storehouses.</i> | He gathers the waters of the sea into jars; He puts the deep into storehouses. |
| 8 | <i>Let all the earth fear the LORD: let all the inhabitants of the world stand in awe of him.</i> | Let all the earth fear the LORD; let all the people of the world revere him. |
| 9 | <i>For he spake, and it was done; he commanded, and it stood fast.</i> | For He spoke. It came to be; He commanded. It stood firm. |
| 10 | <i>The LORD bringeth the counsel of the heathen to nought: he maketh the devices of the people of none effect.</i> | The LORD foils the plans of the nations; he thwarts the purposes of the peoples. |
| 11 | <i>The counsel of the LORD standeth for ever, the thoughts of his heart to all generations.</i> | But the plans of the LORD stand firm forever, the purposes of His heart through all generations. |
| 12 | <i>Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD; and the people whom he hath chosen for his own inheritance.</i> | Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD, the people he chose for his inheritance. |
| 13 | <i>The LORD looketh from heaven; he beholdeth all the sons of men.</i> | From heaven the LORD looks down and sees all mankind; |

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| 14 | <i>From the place of his habitation he looketh upon all the inhabitants of the earth.</i> | from His dwelling place He watches all who live on earth — |
| 15 | <i>He fashioneth their hearts alike; he considereth all their works.</i> | he who forms the hearts of all, who considers everything they do. |
| 16 | <i>There is no king saved by the multitude of an host: a mighty man is not delivered by much strength.</i> | No king is saved by the size of His army; no warrior escapes by His great strength. |
| 17 | <i>An horse is a vain thing for safety: neither shall he deliver any by his great strength.</i> | A horse is a vain hope for deliverance; despite all its great strength it cannot save. |
| 18 | <i>Behold, the eye of the LORD is upon them that fear him, upon them that hope in his mercy;</i> | But the eyes of the LORD are on those who fear Him, on those whose hope is in His mercy, |
| 19 | <i>To deliver their soul from death, and to keep them alive in famine.</i> | to deliver them from death and keep them alive in famine. |
| 20 | <i>Our soul waiteth for the LORD: he is our help and our shield.</i> | We wait in hope for the LORD; He is our help and our shield. |
| 21 | <i>For our heart shall rejoice in him, because we have trusted in his holy name.</i> | In Him our hearts rejoice, for we trust in His holy name. |
| 22 | <i>Let thy mercy, O LORD, be upon us, according as we hope in thee.</i> | May Your mercy be with us, LORD, even as we put our hope in You. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4** — Ps 12:6; Deut 32:4; Titus 1:2; Ps 119:75; Dan 4:37
v5 — Ps 11:7; Ps 119:64; Ps 45:7; Matt 5:45; Ps 104:24
v6 — Heb 11:3; 2 Pet 3:5; John 1:1-3; Job 33:4; Ps 33:9
v8 — Rev 14:6-7; Ps 96:9-10; Rev 15:4; Ps 22:27; Ps 76:7
v9 — Gen 1:3; Ps 33:6; Ps 148:5-6; Rev 4:11; Heb 11:3
v10 — Ps 21:11; Job 5:12-13; Isa 44:25; Prov 21:30; 2 Sam 15:31
v11 — Prov 19:21; Isa 46:10; Job 23:13; Jer 29:11; Isa 14:24
v12 — Ps 144:15; 1 Pet 2:9; John 15:16; Deut 7:6-8; Titus 2:14
v18 — 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 147:11; Job 36:7; Ps 34:15-20; Heb 6:18

v19 — Ps 37:19; Prov 10:3; Job 5:19-22; John 10:28; Isa 33:16
v20 — Isa 40:31; Ps 27:14; Ps 130:5-6; Ps 115:9-12; 1 Chr 5:20
v22 — Ps 13:5; Matt 9:29; Ps 119:76; Ps 5:11-12; Ps 119:49

Psalm 34

A Psalm of David, when he changed his behavior before Abimelech; who drove him away, and he departed.

The psalmist vows to bless the LORD at all times and invites the humble to magnify God with him. He testifies that the LORD delivers those who fear Him, that the angel of the LORD encamps around them, and that many are the afflictions of the righteous but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

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| 1 | <i>I will bless the LORD at all times: his praise shall continually be in my mouth.</i> | I will extol the LORD at all times; His praise will always be on my lips. |
| 2 | <i>My soul shall make her boast in the LORD: the humble shall hear thereof, and be glad.</i> | I will glory in the LORD; let the afflicted hear and rejoice. |
| 3 | <i>O magnify the LORD with me, and let us exalt his name together.</i> | Glorify the LORD with me; let us exalt His name together. |
| 4 | <i>I sought the LORD, and he heard me, and delivered me from all my fears.</i> | I sought the LORD. He answered me; He delivered me from all my fears. |
| 5 | <i>They looked unto him, and were lightened: and their faces were not ashamed.</i> | Those who look to Him are radiant; their faces are never covered with shame. |
| 6 | <i>This poor man cried, and the LORD heard him, and saved him out of all his troubles.</i> | This poor man called. The LORD heard Him; He saved Him out of all His troubles. |
| 7 | <i>The angel of the LORD encampeth round about them that fear him, and delivereth them.</i> | The angel of the LORD encamps around those who fear Him. He delivers them. |
| 8 | <i>O taste and see that the LORD is good: blessed is the man that trusteth in him.</i> | Taste and see that the LORD is good; blessed is the one who takes refuge in him. |
| 9 | <i>O fear the LORD, ye his saints: for there is no want to them that fear him.</i> | Fear the LORD, You His holy people, for those who fear Him lack nothing. |

- 10 *The young lions do lack, and suffer hunger: but they that seek the LORD shall not want any good thing.* The lions may grow weak and hungry, but those who seek the LORD lack no good thing.
- 11 *Come, ye children, hearken unto me: I will teach you the fear of the LORD.* Come, my children, listen to me; I will teach You the fear of the LORD.
- 12 *What man is he that desireth life, and loveth many days, that he may see good?* Whoever of you loves life and desires to see many good days,
- 13 *Keep thy tongue from evil, and thy lips from speaking guile.* keep Your tongue from evil and Your lips from telling lies;
- 14 *Depart from evil, and do good; seek peace, and pursue it.* turn from evil and do good; seek peace and pursue it.
- 15 *The eyes of the LORD are upon the righteous, and his ears are open unto their cry.* The eyes of the LORD are on the righteous. His ears are attentive to their cry;
- 16 *The face of the LORD is against them that do evil, to cut off the remembrance of them from the earth.* but the face of the LORD is against those who do evil, to blot out their name from the earth.
- 17 *The righteous cry, and the LORD heareth, and delivereth them out of all their troubles.* The righteous cry out. The LORD hears them; He delivers them from all their troubles.
- 18 *The LORD is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart; and saveth such as be of a contrite spirit.* The LORD is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit.
- 19 *Many are the afflictions of the righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all.* The righteous person may have many troubles. But The LORD delivers Him from them all;
- 20 *He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken.* he protects all His bones, not one of them will be broken.
- 21 *Evil shall slay the wicked: and they that hate the righteous shall be desolate.* Evil will slay the wicked; the foes of the righteous will be condemned.

- 22

The LORD redeemeth the soul of his servants: and none of them that trust in him shall be desolate.
- The LORD will rescue His servants; no one who takes refuge in him will be condemned.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Thess 5:18; Col 3:17; Ps 145:1-2; Eph 5:20; Ps 71:8
- v3 — Ps 69:30; Luke 1:46; Ps 148:1-14; Rev 19:5-6; Ps 40:16
- v4 — Ps 18:6; Matt 7:7; Ps 116:1-6; Ps 56:3; 2 Tim 1:7
- v5 — Heb 12:2; Ps 123:1-2; Ps 18:28; Ps 25:3; Ps 36:9
- v7 — Ps 91:11; Dan 6:22; Heb 1:14; 2 Kgs 19:35; 2 Kgs 6:17
- v8 — Ps 119:103; Heb 6:4-5; 1 Pet 2:2-3; Jer 31:14; Ps 63:5
- v10 — Ps 84:11; Matt 6:32; Ps 104:21; Luke 1:51-53; Job 4:10-11
- v14 — Ps 37:27; 1 Pet 3:11; Heb 12:14; 3 John 1:11; Rom 12:9
- v15 — 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 34:17; Ps 33:18; Job 36:7; Ps 130:2
- v17 — Ps 145:18-20; Isa 65:24; Ps 34:19; Ps 34:6; Ps 91:15
- v18 — Ps 147:3; Ps 145:18; Isa 57:15; Isa 61:1; Ps 51:17
- v19 — Ps 34:17; 1 Pet 4:12-13; 2 Cor 4:17; Ps 34:6; John 16:33

Psalm 35

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist calls on the LORD to take up shield and spear and fight against those who persecute him without cause. He describes false witnesses who repay his good with evil, and asks God to vindicate him and put his enemies to shame.

- 1

Plead my cause, O LORD, with them that strive with me: fight against them that fight against me.
- Contend, LORD, with those who contend with me; fight against those who fight against me.
- 2

Take hold of shield and buckler, and stand up for mine help.
- Take up shield and armor; arise and come to my aid.
- 3

Draw out also the spear, and stop the way against them that persecute me: say unto my soul, I am thy salvation.
- Brandish spear and javelin against those who pursue me. Say to me, "I am Your salvation."
- 4

Let them be confounded and put to shame that seek after my soul: let them be turned back and brought to confusion that devise my hurt.
- May those who seek my life be disgraced and put to shame; may those who plot my ruin be turned back in dismay.

- 5 *Let them be as chaff before the wind:
and let the angel of the LORD chase
them.* May they be like chaff before the
wind, with the angel of the LORD
driving them away;
- 6 *Let their way be dark and slippery:
and let the angel of the LORD
persecute them.* may their path be dark and slippery,
with the angel of the LORD pursuing
them.
- 7 *For without cause have they hid for
me their net in a pit, which without
cause they have digged for my soul.* Since they hid their net for me without
cause and without cause dug a pit for
me,
- 8 *Let destruction come upon him at
unawares; and let his net that he hath
hid catch himself: into that very
destruction let him fall.* may ruin overtake them by surprise —
may the net they hid entangle them,
may they fall into the pit, to their ruin.
- 9 *And my soul shall be joyful in the
LORD: it shall rejoice in his
salvation.* Then my soul will rejoice in the LORD
and delight in His salvation.
- 10 *All my bones shall say, LORD, who is
like unto thee, which deliverest the
poor from him that is too strong for
him, yea, the poor and the needy from
him that spoileth him?* My whole being will exclaim, "Who is
like You, LORD? You rescue the poor
from those too strong for them, the
poor and needy from those who rob
them."
- 11 *False witnesses did rise up; they laid
to my charge things that I knew not.* Ruthless witnesses come forward; they
question me on things I know nothing
about.
- 12 *They rewarded me evil for good to the
spoiling of my soul.* They repay me evil for good and leave
me like one bereaved.
- 13 *But as for me, when they were sick,
my clothing was sackcloth: I humbled
my soul with fasting; and my prayer
returned into mine own bosom.* Yet when they were ill, I put on
sackcloth and humbled myself with
fasting. When my prayers returned to
me unanswered,
- 14 *I behaved myself as though he had
been my friend or brother: I bowed
down heavily, as one that mourneth
for his mother.* I went about mourning as though for
my friend or brother. I bowed my head
in grief as though weeping for my
mother.

- 15 *But in mine adversity they rejoiced,
and gathered themselves together:
yea, the abjects gathered themselves
together against me, and I knew it
not; they did tear me, and ceased not:* But when I stumbled, they gathered in
glee; assailants gathered against me
without my knowledge. They
slandered me without ceasing.
- 16 *With hypocritical mockers in feasts,
they gnashed upon me with their teeth.* Like the ungodly they maliciously
mocked; they gnashed their teeth at
me.
- 17 *Lord, how long wilt thou look on?
rescue my soul from their
destructions, my darling from the
lions.* How long, Lord, will You look on?
Rescue me from their ravages, my
precious life from these lions.
- 18 *I will give thee thanks in the great
congregation: I will praise thee
among much people.* I will give You thanks in the great
assembly; among the throngs I will
praise You.
- 19 *Let not them that are mine enemies
wrongfully rejoice over me: neither
let them wink with the eye that hate
me without a cause.* Do not let those gloat over me who are
my enemies without cause; do not let
those who hate me without reason
maliciously wink the eye.
- 20 *For they speak not peace: but they
devise deceitful matters against them
that are quiet in the land.* They do not speak peaceably, but
devise false accusations against those
who live quietly in the land.
- 21 *Yea, they opened their mouth wide
against me, and said, Aha, aha, our
eye hath seen it.* They sneer at me and say, "Aha! Aha!
With our own eyes we have seen it."
- 22 *This thou hast seen, O LORD: keep
not silence: O Lord, be not far from
me.* LORD, You have seen this; do not be
silent. Do not be far from me, Lord.
- 23 *Stir up thyself, and awake to my
judgment, even unto my cause, my
God and my Lord.* Awake, and rise to my defense!
Contend for me, my God and Lord.
- 24 *Judge me, O LORD my God,
according to thy righteousness; and
let them not rejoice over me.* Vindicate me in Your righteousness,
LORD my God; do not let them gloat
over me.

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| <p>25 <i>Let them not say in their hearts, Ah, so would we have it: let them not say, We have swallowed him up.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Let them be ashamed and brought to confusion together that rejoice at mine hurt: let them be clothed with shame and dishonour that magnify themselves against me.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Let them shout for joy, and be glad, that favour my righteous cause: yea, let them say continually, Let the LORD be magnified, which hath pleasure in the prosperity of his servant.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And my tongue shall speak of thy righteousness and of thy praise all the day long.</i></p> | <p>Do not let them think, "Aha, just what we wanted!" or say, "We have swallowed Him up."</p> <p>May all who gloat over my distress be put to shame and confusion; may all who exalt themselves over me be clothed with shame and disgrace.</p> <p>May those who delight in my vindication shout for joy and gladness; may they always say, "The LORD be exalted, who delights in the well-being of His servant."</p> <p>My tongue will proclaim Your righteousness, Your praises all day long.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 43:1; Jer 51:36; Ps 119:154; Isa 49:25; Prov 22:23
- v2 — Ps 91:4; Ex 15:3; Isa 42:13; Deut 32:41-42; Ps 7:12-13
- v3 — Isa 12:2; Ps 27:2; Ps 91:16; Ps 51:12
- v4 — Ps 70:2-3; Ps 35:26; Jer 46:5; Ps 38:12; Ps 31:17-18
- v7 — John 15:25; Ps 140:5; Ps 9:15
- v8 — Ps 141:9-10; Luke 21:34; Ps 9:15; Prov 5:22; 1 Thess 5:3
- v10 — Ps 140:12; Ex 15:11; Ps 86:8; Ps 109:31; Ps 51:8
- v12 — John 10:32; Jer 18:20; Ps 38:20; Luke 23:21-23; Prov 17:13
- v13 — Ps 69:10-11; Job 30:25; Matt 5:44
- v19 — Ps 69:4; John 15:25; Prov 6:13; Ps 13:4; Ps 38:19
- v23 — Ps 7:6; Ps 44:23; Ps 89:26; Ps 59:4
- v27 — Jer 32:40-41; Ps 149:4; Ps 40:16; Zeph 3:17; Prov 8:18

Psalm 36

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David the servant of the LORD.

The psalmist describes the wicked who have no fear of God and flatter themselves in their own eyes. He contrasts this with the LORD whose mercy reaches to the heavens, whose faithfulness to the clouds, and in whose light we see light.

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| 1 | <i>The transgression of the wicked saith within my heart, that there is no fear of God before his eyes.</i> | I have a message from God in my heart concerning the sinfulness of the wicked: there is no fear of God before their eyes. |
| 2 | <i>For he flattereth himself in his own eyes, until his iniquity be found to be hateful.</i> | In their own eyes they flatter themselves too much to detect or hate their sin. |
| 3 | <i>The words of his mouth are iniquity and deceit: he hath left off to be wise, and to do good.</i> | The words of their mouths are wicked and deceitful; they fail to act wisely or do good. |
| 4 | <i>He deviseth mischief upon his bed; he setteth himself in a way that is not good; he abhorreth not evil.</i> | Even on their beds they plot evil; they commit themselves to a sinful course and do not reject what is wrong. |
| 5 | <i>Thy mercy, O LORD, is in the heavens; and thy faithfulness reacheth unto the clouds.</i> | Your mercy, LORD, is in the heavens, and Your faithfulness reaches to the clouds. |
| 6 | <i>Thy righteousness is like the great mountains; thy judgments are a great deep: O LORD, thou preservest man and beast.</i> | Your righteousness is like the highest mountains, Your justice like the great deep. You, LORD, preserve both people and animals. |
| 7 | <i>How excellent is thy lovingkindness, O God! therefore the children of men put their trust under the shadow of thy wings.</i> | How excellent is Your lovingkindness, O God! Therefore the children of men put their trust under the shadow of Your wings. |
| 8 | <i>They shall be abundantly satisfied with the fatness of thy house; and thou shalt make them drink of the river of thy pleasures.</i> | They feast on the abundance of Your house; You give them drink from Your river of delights. |
| 9 | <i>For with thee is the fountain of life: in thy light shall we see light.</i> | For with You is the fountain of life; in Your light we see light. |

10	<i>O continue thy lovingkindness unto them that know thee; and thy righteousness to the upright in heart.</i>	Continue Your lovingkindness to those who know You, and Your righteousness to the upright in heart.
11	<i>Let not the foot of pride come against me, and let not the hand of the wicked remove me.</i>	May the foot of the proud not come against me, nor the hand of the wicked drive me away.
12	<i>There are the workers of iniquity fallen: they are cast down, and shall not be able to rise.</i>	See how the evildoers lie fallen — thrown down, not able to rise!

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 3:18; Prov 16:6
- v2 — Deut 29:19; Ps 49:18
- v4 — Prov 4:16; Mic 2:1; Isa 65:2; Rom 12:9
- v5 — Ps 100:5; Ps 108:4; Ps 103:11; Ps 57:10; Ps 89:2
- v6 — Rom 11:33
- v7 — Ps 86:5; 1 John 3:1; Ruth 2:12; Ps 91:4; 1 John 4:9-10
- v8 — Ps 16:11; Ps 65:4; Isa 58:11; Jer 31:12-14; Ps 63:5
- v9 — John 8:12; John 4:14; 1 John 1:7; John 4:10; John 7:37-39
- v10 — Jer 24:7; Heb 8:11; Jer 22:16; Ps 97:10-11; Ps 9:10
- v11 — Ps 16:8
- v12 — Ps 1:5

Psalm 37

A Psalm of David.

The psalmist counsels against fretting over evildoers, for they shall soon be cut down like grass. He urges trust in the LORD, delight in Him, and commitment of one's way to God, promising that the meek shall inherit the earth and the righteous shall never be forsaken.

1	<i>Fret not thyself because of evildoers, neither be thou envious against the workers of iniquity.</i>	Do not fret because of those who are evil or be envious of those who do wrong;
2	<i>For they shall soon be cut down like the grass, and wither as the green herb.</i>	for like the grass they will soon wither, like green plants they will soon die away.

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| 3 | <i>Trust in the LORD, and do good; so shalt thou dwell in the land, and verily thou shalt be fed.</i> | Trust in the LORD and do good; dwell in the land and enjoy safe pasture. |
| 4 | <i>Delight thyself also in the LORD; and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart.</i> | Take delight in the LORD. He will give You the desires of Your heart. |
| 5 | <i>Commit thy way unto the LORD; trust also in him; and he shall bring it to pass.</i> | Commit Your way to the LORD; trust in Him and He will do this: |
| 6 | <i>And he shall bring forth thy righteousness as the light, and thy judgment as the noonday.</i> | He will make Your righteous reward shine like the dawn, Your vindication like the noonday sun. |
| 7 | <i>Rest in the LORD, and wait patiently for him: fret not thyself because of him who prospereth in his way, because of the man who bringeth wicked devices to pass.</i> | Be still before the LORD and wait patiently for Him; do not fret when people succeed in their ways, when they carry out their wicked schemes. |
| 8 | <i>Cease from anger, and forsake wrath: fret not thyself in any wise to do evil.</i> | Refrain from anger and turn from wrath; do not fret — it leads only to evil. |
| 9 | <i>For evildoers shall be cut off: but those that wait upon the LORD, they shall inherit the earth.</i> | For those who are evil will be destroyed, but those who hope in the LORD will inherit the land. |
| 10 | <i>For yet a little while, and the wicked shall not be: yea, thou shalt diligently consider his place, and it shall not be.</i> | A little while, and the wicked will be no more; though you look for them, they will not be found. |
| 11 | <i>But the meek shall inherit the earth; and shall delight themselves in the abundance of peace.</i> | But the meek will inherit the land and enjoy peace and prosperity. |
| 12 | <i>The wicked plotteth against the just, and gnasheth upon him with his teeth.</i> | The wicked plot against the righteous and gnash their teeth at them; |
| 13 | <i>The Lord shall laugh at him: for he seeth that his day is coming.</i> | but the Lord laughs at the wicked, for he knows their day is coming. |

- 14 *The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow, to cast down the poor and needy, and to slay such as be of upright conversation.* The wicked draw the sword and bend the bow to bring down the poor and needy, to slay those whose ways are upright.
- 15 *Their sword shall enter into their own heart, and their bows shall be broken.* But their swords will pierce their own hearts. Their bows will be broken.
- 16 *A little that a righteous man hath is better than the riches of many wicked.* Better the little that the righteous have than the wealth of many wicked;
- 17 *For the arms of the wicked shall be broken: but the LORD upholdeth the righteous.* for the power of the wicked will be broken. But The LORD upholds the righteous.
- 18 *The LORD knoweth the days of the upright: and their inheritance shall be for ever.* The blameless spend their days under the LORD's care. Their inheritance will endure forever.
- 19 *They shall not be ashamed in the evil time: and in the days of famine they shall be satisfied.* In times of disaster they will not wither; in days of famine they will enjoy plenty.
- 20 *But the wicked shall perish, and the enemies of the LORD shall be as the fat of lambs: they shall consume; into smoke shall they consume away.* But the wicked will perish: though the LORD's enemies are like the flowers of the field, they will be consumed, they will go up in smoke.
- 21 *The wicked borroweth, and payeth not again: but the righteous sheweth mercy, and giveth.* The wicked borrow and do not repay, but the righteous give generously;
- 22 *For such as be blessed of him shall inherit the earth; and they that be cursed of him shall be cut off.* those the LORD blesses will inherit the land, but those He curses will be destroyed.
- 23 *The steps of a good man are ordered by the LORD: and he delighteth in his way.* The LORD makes firm the steps of the one who delights in him;
- 24 *Though he fall, he shall not be utterly cast down: for the LORD upholdeth him with his hand.* though He may stumble, He will not fall, for the LORD upholds Him with His hand.

- 25 *I have been young, and now am old;
yet have I not seen the righteous
forsaken, nor his seed begging bread.* I was young and now I am old, yet I
have never seen the righteous forsaken
or their children begging bread.
- 26 *He is ever merciful, and lendeth; and
his seed is blessed.* They are always generous and lend
freely; their children will be a blessing.
- 27 *Depart from evil, and do good; and
dwell for evermore.* Turn from evil and do good; then You
will dwell in the land forever.
- 28 *For the LORD loveth judgment, and
forsaketh not his saints; they are
preserved for ever: but the seed of the
wicked shall be cut off.* For the LORD loves the just and will
not forsake His faithful ones.
Wrongdoers will be completely
destroyed; the seed of the wicked will
perish.
- 29 *The righteous shall inherit the land,
and dwell therein for ever.* The righteous will inherit the land and
dwell in it forever.
- 30 *The mouth of the righteous speaketh
wisdom, and his tongue talketh of
judgment.* The mouths of the righteous utter
wisdom. Their tongues speak what is
just.
- 31 *The law of his God is in his heart;
none of his steps shall slide.* The law of their God is in their hearts;
their feet do not slip.
- 32 *The wicked watcheth the righteous,
and seeketh to slay him.* The wicked lie in wait for the
righteous, intent on putting them to
death;
- 33 *The LORD will not leave him in his
hand, nor condemn him when he is
judged.* but the LORD will not leave them in
the power of the wicked or let them be
condemned when brought to trial.
- 34 *Wait on the LORD, and keep his way,
and he shall exalt thee to inherit the
land: when the wicked are cut off,
thou shalt see it.* Hope in the LORD and keep His way.
He will exalt You to inherit the land;
when the wicked are destroyed, you
will see it.
- 35 *I have seen the wicked in great power,
and spreading himself like a green
bay tree.* I have seen a wicked and ruthless man
flourishing like a luxuriant native tree,

36	<i>Yet he passed away, and, lo, he was not: yea, I sought him, but he could not be found.</i>	but He soon passed away and was no more; though I looked for Him, He could not be found.
37	<i>Mark the perfect man, and behold the upright: for the end of that man is peace.</i>	Consider the blameless, observe the upright; a future awaits those who seek peace.
38	<i>But the transgressors shall be destroyed together: the end of the wicked shall be cut off.</i>	But all sinners will be destroyed; there will be no future for the wicked.
39	<i>But the salvation of the righteous is of the LORD: he is their strength in the time of trouble.</i>	The salvation of the righteous comes from the LORD; He is their stronghold in time of trouble.
40	<i>And the LORD shall help them, and deliver them: he shall deliver them from the wicked, and save them, because they trust in him.</i>	The LORD helps them and delivers them; He delivers them from the wicked and saves them, because they take refuge in Him.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 37:7; Prov 23:17; Prov 24:19; Prov 3:31; Prov 24:1
- v3 — Jer 17:7-8; Matt 6:31-33; Ps 62:8; 1 Cor 15:57-58; Ps 34:9-10
- v4 — John 15:7; Ps 145:19; John 15:16; Isa 58:14; 1 John 5:14-15
- v5 — Prov 16:3; 1 Pet 5:7; Phil 4:6-7; Matt 6:25; Ps 55:22
- v6 — Isa 54:17; Job 11:17; Isa 58:8; Mic 7:8-9; Matt 13:43
- v7 — Jas 5:7-11; Ps 27:14; Ps 62:5; Heb 10:36-37; Lam 3:25-26
- v8 — Prov 14:29; Prov 16:32; Jas 1:19-20; Eph 4:31; Eph 4:26
- v11 — Matt 5:5; Isa 26:3; Gal 5:22-23; Jas 3:13; Ps 119:165
- v17 — Isa 41:10; Ps 63:8; Ps 145:14; Isa 42:1; Ps 37:24
- v23 — Prov 16:9; Ps 119:133; Prov 4:26; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 40:2
- v24 — Prov 24:16; Ps 145:14; Ps 94:18; Mic 7:7-8; John 10:27-30
- v25 — Heb 13:5; Ps 37:28; Ps 25:13; 1 Sam 12:22; Ps 112:2

Psalm 38

A Psalm of David, to bring to remembrance.

The psalmist groans under the LORD's chastening hand, confessing that his iniquities have gone over his head like a heavy burden. His wounds stink, his friends stand far off, and his

enemies plot against him, yet he waits silently for the LORD and pleads: do not forsake me.

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| 1 | <i>O LORD, rebuke me not in thy wrath: neither chasten me in thy hot displeasure.</i> | LORD, do not rebuke me in Your anger or discipline me in Your wrath. |
| 2 | <i>For thine arrows stick fast in me, and thy hand presseth me sore.</i> | Your arrows have pierced me, and Your hand has come down on me. |
| 3 | <i>There is no soundness in my flesh because of thine anger; neither is there any rest in my bones because of my sin.</i> | Because of Your wrath there is no health in my body; there is no soundness in my bones because of my sin. |
| 4 | <i>For mine iniquities are gone over mine head: as an heavy burden they are too heavy for me.</i> | My guilt has overwhelmed me like a burden too heavy to bear. |
| 5 | <i>My wounds stink and are corrupt because of my foolishness.</i> | My wounds fester and are loathsome because of my sinful folly. |
| 6 | <i>I am troubled; I am bowed down greatly; I go mourning all the day long.</i> | I am bowed down and brought very low; all day long I go about mourning. |
| 7 | <i>For my loins are filled with a loathsome disease: and there is no soundness in my flesh.</i> | My back is filled with searing pain; there is no health in my body. |
| 8 | <i>I am feeble and sore broken: I have roared by reason of the disquietness of my heart.</i> | I am feeble and utterly crushed; I groan in anguish of heart. |
| 9 | <i>Lord, all my desire is before thee; and my groaning is not hid from thee.</i> | All my longings lie open before You, Lord; my sighing is not hidden from You. |
| 10 | <i>My heart panteth, my strength faileth me: as for the light of mine eyes, it also is gone from me.</i> | My heart pounds, my strength fails me; even the light has gone from my eyes. |
| 11 | <i>My lovers and my friends stand aloof from my sore; and my kinsmen stand afar off.</i> | My friends and companions avoid me because of my wounds; my neighbors stay far away. |

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| <p>12 <i>They also that seek after my life lay snares for me: and they that seek my hurt speak mischievous things, and imagine deceits all the day long.</i></p> <p>13 <i>But I, as a deaf man, heard not; and I was as a dumb man that openeth not his mouth.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Thus I was as a man that heareth not, and in whose mouth are no reproofs.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For in thee, O LORD, do I hope: thou wilt hear, O Lord my God.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For I said, Hear me, lest otherwise they should rejoice over me: when my foot slippeth, they magnify themselves against me.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For I am ready to halt, and my sorrow is continually before me.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For I will declare mine iniquity; I will be sorry for my sin.</i></p> <p>19 <i>But mine enemies are lively, and they are strong: and they that hate me wrongfully are multiplied.</i></p> <p>20 <i>They also that render evil for good are mine adversaries; because I follow the thing that good is.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Forsake me not, O LORD: O my God, be not far from me.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Make haste to help me, O Lord my salvation.</i></p> | <p>Those who want to kill me set their traps, those who would harm me talk of my ruin; all day long they scheme and lie.</p> <p>I am like the deaf, who cannot hear, like the mute, who cannot speak;</p> <p>I have become like one who does not hear, whose mouth can offer no reply.</p> <p>LORD, I wait for You; You will answer, Lord my God.</p> <p>For I said, "Do not let them gloat or exalt themselves over me when my feet slip."</p> <p>For I am about to fall, and my pain is ever with me.</p> <p>I confess my iniquity; I am troubled by my sin.</p> <p>Many have become my enemies without cause; those who hate me without reason are numerous.</p> <p>Those who repay my good with evil lodge accusations against me, though I seek only to do what is good.</p> <p>LORD, do not forsake me; do not be far from me, my God.</p> <p>Come quickly to help me, my Lord and my Savior.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 54:8; Heb 12:5-11; Ps 6:1; Ps 70:1; Jer 30:11

- v2 — Job 6:4; Ps 32:4
 v4 — Ps 40:12; Ezra 9:6; Matt 11:28; Lam 1:14
 v6 — Job 30:28; Ps 35:14
 v9 — Ps 10:17; 2 Cor 5:2; Ps 6:6; Rom 8:26-27
 v11 — Luke 23:49; Ps 31:11; Job 19:13-17
 v15 — Ps 39:7; Ps 17:6; Ps 138:3
 v17 — Ps 6:6; Ps 35:15; Ps 38:6; Isa 53:3-5; Ps 77:2-3
 v18 — Prov 28:13; Ps 32:5; Job 33:27; Ps 51:3
 v20 — Ps 35:12; Jer 18:20; 1 John 3:12; John 10:32; 1 Pet 4:14-16
 v21 — Ps 22:19; Ps 22:24
 v22 — Ps 40:13; Ps 27:1; Isa 12:2; Ps 71:12; Ps 141:1

Psalm 39

To the chief Musician, even to Jeduthun. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist resolves to guard his tongue but cannot hold back his grief. He asks the LORD to show him the measure of his days and confesses that every man at his best state is altogether vanity. He prays: spare me before I go away and am no more.

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| <p>1 <i>I said, I will take heed to my ways,
that I sin not with my tongue: I will
keep my mouth with a bridle, while
the wicked is before me.</i></p> | <p>I said, "I will watch my ways and keep
my tongue from sin; I will put a
muzzle on my mouth while in the
presence of the wicked."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>I was dumb with silence, I held my
peace, even from good; and my
sorrow was stirred.</i></p> | <p>So I remained utterly silent, not even
saying anything good. But my anguish
increased;</p> |
| <p>3 <i>My heart was hot within me, while I
was musing the fire burned: then
spake I with my tongue,</i></p> | <p>my heart grew hot within me. While I
meditated, the fire burned; then I spoke
with my tongue:</p> |
| <p>4 <i>LORD, make me to know mine end,
and the measure of my days, what it
is; that I may know how frail I am.</i></p> | <p>"Show me, LORD, my life's end and
the number of my days; let me know
how fleeting my life is.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Behold, thou hast made my days as an
handbreadth; and mine age is as
nothing before thee: verily every man
at his best state is altogether vanity.
Selah.</i></p> | <p>You have made my days a mere
handbreadth; the span of my years is as
nothing before You. Everyone is but a
breath, even those who seem secure.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>Surely every man walketh in a vain shew: surely they are disquieted in vain: he heapeth up riches, and knoweth not who shall gather them.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And now, Lord, what wait I for? my hope is in thee.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Deliver me from all my transgressions: make me not the reproach of the foolish.</i></p> <p>9 <i>I was dumb, I opened not my mouth; because thou didst it.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Remove thy stroke away from me: I am consumed by the blow of thine hand.</i></p> <p>11 <i>When thou with rebukes dost correct man for iniquity, thou makest his beauty to consume away like a moth: surely every man is vanity. Selah.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Hear my prayer, O LORD, and give ear unto my cry; hold not thy peace at my tears: for I am a stranger with thee, and a sojourner, as all my fathers were.</i></p> <p>13 <i>O spare me, that I may recover strength, before I go hence, and be no more.</i></p> | <p>Surely everyone goes around like a mere phantom; in vain they rush about, heaping up wealth without knowing whose it will finally be.</p> <p>But now, Lord, what do I look for? My hope is in You.</p> <p>Save me from all my transgressions; do not make me the scorn of fools.</p> <p>I was silent; I would not open my mouth, for You are the one who has done this.</p> <p>Remove Your scourge from me; I am overcome by the blow of Your hand.</p> <p>When You rebuke and discipline anyone for their sin, you consume their wealth like a moth — surely everyone is but a breath.</p> <p>Hear my prayer, LORD, listen to my cry for help; do not be deaf to my weeping. I dwell with You as a foreigner, a stranger, as all my ancestors were.</p> <p>Look away from me, that I may enjoy life again before I depart and am no more."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Prov 21:23; Ps 141:3; Jas 1:26; Ps 119:9; Ps 34:13

v3 — Jer 20:9; Luke 24:32

v4 — Ps 90:12; Ps 103:14; Job 14:13; Ps 119:84

v5 — Ps 89:47; Ps 144:4; Ps 62:9; Ps 90:9-10; Eccl 2:11

v6 — Luke 12:20-21; Eccl 2:26; Jas 4:14; 1 Cor 7:31; Eccl 12:13

v7 — Rom 15:13; Ps 38:15; Ps 119:81; Gen 49:18; Job 13:15

v8 — Ps 44:13

v9 — Job 2:10

v10 — Job 9:34; Job 13:21

v11 — Job 13:28; Heb 12:6; 1 Cor 11:30-32; Rev 3:19; Isa 50:9

v12 — 1 Pet 2:11; Heb 11:13; Lev 25:23; 2 Kgs 20:5; Ps 116:3

v13 — Job 14:5-6; Job 10:20-21; Job 14:10-12; Job 7:19

Psalm 40

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist testifies that the LORD pulled him out of a horrible pit and set his feet on a rock. He declares that God desires no sacrifice or offering but an open ear, and says, "In the volume of the book it is written of me -- I delight to do your will." He closes pleading for swift deliverance.

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| <p>1 <i>I waited patiently for the LORD; and he inclined unto me, and heard my cry.</i></p> | <p>I waited patiently for the LORD; He turned to me and heard my cry.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>He brought me up also out of an horrible pit, out of the miry clay, and set my feet upon a rock, and established my goings.</i></p> | <p>He lifted me out of the slimy pit, out of the mud and mire; He set my feet on a rock and gave me a firm place to stand.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he hath put a new song in my mouth, even praise unto our God: many shall see it, and fear, and shall trust in the LORD.</i></p> | <p>He put a new song in my mouth, a hymn of praise to our God. Many will see and fear the LORD and put their trust in Him.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Blessed is that man that maketh the LORD his trust, and respecteth not the proud, nor such as turn aside to lies.</i></p> | <p>Blessed is the one who trusts in the LORD, Who does not look to the proud, to those who turn aside to false gods.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Many, O LORD my God, are thy wonderful works which thou hast done, and thy thoughts which are to us-ward: they cannot be reckoned up in order unto thee: if I would declare and speak of them, they are more than can be numbered.</i></p> | <p>Many, LORD my God, are the wonders You have done, the things You planned for us. None can compare with You; were I to speak and tell of Your deeds, they would be too many to declare.</p> |

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| 6 <i>Sacrifice and offering thou didst not desire; mine ears hast thou opened: burnt offering and sin offering hast thou not required.</i> | Sacrifice and offering You did not desire — but my ears You have opened — burnt offerings and sin offerings You did not require. |
| 7 <i>Then said I, Lo, I come: in the volume of the book it is written of me,</i> | Then I said, "Here I am, I have come — it is written about me in the scroll. |
| 8 <i>I delight to do thy will, O my God: yea, thy law is within my heart.</i> | I desire to do Your will, my God; Your law is within my heart." |
| 9 <i>I have preached righteousness in the great congregation: lo, I have not refrained my lips, O LORD, thou knowest.</i> | I proclaim Your saving acts in the great assembly; I do not seal my lips, LORD, as You know. |
| 10 <i>I have not hid thy righteousness within my heart; I have declared thy faithfulness and thy salvation: I have not concealed thy lovingkindness and thy truth from the great congregation.</i> | I have not hidden Your righteousness within my heart; I have declared Your faithfulness and Your salvation. I have not concealed Your lovingkindness and Your truth from the great congregation. |
| 11 <i>Withhold not thou thy tender mercies from me, O LORD: let thy lovingkindness and thy truth continually preserve me.</i> | Do not withhold Your tender mercies from me, LORD; let Your lovingkindness and Your truth continually preserve me. |
| 12 <i>For innumerable evils have compassed me about: mine iniquities have taken hold upon me, so that I am not able to look up; they are more than the hairs of mine head: therefore my heart faileth me.</i> | For troubles without number surround me; my sins have overtaken me. I cannot see. They are more than the hairs of my head, and my heart fails within me. |
| 13 <i>Be pleased, O LORD, to deliver me: O LORD, make haste to help me.</i> | Be pleased to save me, LORD; come quickly, LORD, to help me. |

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| 14 <i>Let them be ashamed and confounded together that seek after my soul to destroy it; let them be driven backward and put to shame that wish me evil.</i> | May all who want to take my life be put to shame and confusion; may all who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace. |
| 15 <i>Let them be desolate for a reward of their shame that say unto me, Aha, aha.</i> | May those who say to me, "Aha! Aha!" be appalled at their own shame. |
| 16 <i>Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee: let such as love thy salvation say continually, The LORD be magnified.</i> | But may all who seek You rejoice and be glad in You; may those who long for Your saving help always say, "The LORD is great!" |
| 17 <i>But I am poor and needy; yet the Lord thinketh upon me: thou art my help and my deliverer; make no tarrying, O my God.</i> | But as for me, I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my help and my deliverer; You are my God, do not delay. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 27:13-14; Ps 37:7; Jas 5:7-11; Ps 116:2; Ps 34:15
- v2 — Ps 37:23; Ps 119:133; Ps 27:5; Matt 7:24-25; Ps 61:2
- v3 — Ps 33:3; Ps 103:1-5; Ps 34:1-6; Ps 52:6; Rev 5:9-10
- v4 — Jer 17:7-8; Ps 84:11-12; Ps 34:8; Ps 125:5; Ps 118:8-9
- v5 — Jer 29:11; Ps 139:17-18; Ex 15:11; Ps 71:15; Ps 92:5
- v6 — Heb 10:5-12; Isa 1:11; 1 Sam 15:22; Ps 51:16; Hos 6:6
- v7 — Heb 10:7-9; Luke 24:44; John 5:39; Luke 24:27; 1 Cor 15:3-4
- v8 — Rom 7:22; John 4:34; Jer 15:16; Ps 119:24; Ps 119:16
- v9 — Ps 22:25; Mark 16:15-16; Ps 22:22; Ps 119:13; Ps 71:15-18
- v11 — Ps 23:6; Ps 43:3; Ps 57:3; Prov 20:28; Ps 61:7
- v16 — Ps 35:27; Ps 68:3; Acts 19:17; Ps 119:123
- v17 — Ps 70:5; Isa 41:17; Heb 13:6; 1 Pet 5:7; Ps 34:6

Psalm 41

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist pronounces blessing on the one who considers the poor. He confesses his own sin, describes the betrayal of a close friend who lifted his heel against him, and closes with a

doxology blessing the LORD God of Israel from everlasting to everlasting.

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| 1 <i>Blessed is he that considereth the poor: the LORD will deliver him in time of trouble.</i> | Blessed are those who have regard for the weak; the LORD delivers them in times of trouble. |
| 2 <i>The LORD will preserve him, and keep him alive; and he shall be blessed upon the earth: and thou wilt not deliver him unto the will of his enemies.</i> | The LORD protects and preserves them — they are counted among the blessed in the land — He does not give them over to the desire of their foes. |
| 3 <i>The LORD will strengthen him upon the bed of languishing: thou wilt make all his bed in his sickness.</i> | The LORD sustains them on their sickbed and restores them from their bed of illness. |
| 4 <i>I said, LORD, be merciful unto me: heal my soul; for I have sinned against thee.</i> | I said, "Have mercy on me, LORD; heal me, for I have sinned against You." |
| 5 <i>Mine enemies speak evil of me, When shall he die, and his name perish?</i> | My enemies say of me in malice, "When will He die and His name perish?" |
| 6 <i>And if he come to see me, he speaketh vanity: his heart gathereth iniquity to itself; when he goeth abroad, he telleth it.</i> | When one of them comes to see me, He speaks falsely, while His heart gathers slander; then He goes out and spreads it around. |
| 7 <i>All that hate me whisper together against me: against me do they devise my hurt.</i> | All my enemies whisper together against me; they imagine the worst for me, saying, |
| 8 <i>An evil disease, say they, cleaveth fast unto him: and now that he lieth he shall rise up no more.</i> | "A vile disease has afflicted Him; He will never get up from the place where He lies." |
| 9 <i>Yea, mine own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, which did eat of my bread, hath lifted up his heel against me.</i> | Even my close friend, someone I trusted, one who shared my bread, has turned against me. |

10	<i>But thou, O LORD, be merciful unto me, and raise me up, that I may requite them.</i>	But may You have mercy on me, LORD; raise me up, that I may repay them.
11	<i>By this I know that thou favourest me, because mine enemy doth not triumph over me.</i>	I know that You are pleased with me, for my enemy does not triumph over me.
12	<i>And as for me, thou upholdest me in mine integrity, and settest me before thy face for ever.</i>	Because of my integrity You uphold me and set me in Your presence forever.
13	<i>Blessed be the LORD God of Israel from everlasting, and to everlasting. Amen, and Amen.</i>	Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen and Amen.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 19:17; Prov 14:21; 2 Cor 9:8-14; Acts 20:35; Matt 25:34-39
- v2 — Jer 45:4-5; Ps 27:12; 1 Tim 4:8; Ps 33:19; Ps 37:32-33
- v3 — 2 Kgs 20:5-6; Ps 73:26; Phil 2:26-27; 2 Cor 4:16-17; 2 Kgs 1:16
- v4 — Ps 103:3; Jas 5:15-16; Hos 6:1; 2 Chr 30:18-20
- v5 — Prov 10:7; Ps 102:8
- v6 — Ps 12:2; Luke 11:53-54; Prov 26:24-26
- v7 — Prov 16:28
- v9 — John 13:18; Ps 55:12-14; Matt 26:23; John 13:26-27; Ps 55:20-22
- v11 — Col 2:15; Ps 124:6; Ps 25:2; Ps 147:11; Jer 20:13
- v12 — Job 36:7; Ps 73:23-24
- v13 — Ps 72:18-19; Eph 1:3; Rev 4:8; Rev 5:9-14; Ps 89:52

Psalm 42

To the chief Musician. Maschil, for the Sons of Korah.

The psalmist pants for God as a deer pants for streams of water, his soul thirsting for the living God. Tears are his food day and night as enemies taunt him, yet he preaches to his own soul: "Hope in God, for I shall yet praise Him."

1	<i>As the hart panteth after the water brooks, so panteth my soul after thee, O God.</i>	As the deer pants for streams of water, so my soul pants for you, my God.
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sons of Korah** (KOHR-ah) — *Levitical singers and temple musicians. Their ancestor Korah led a rebellion against Moses and was swallowed by the earth (Numbers 16), but his sons were spared. Their descendants became worship leaders, and eleven Psalms bear their name (42–49, 84–85, 87–88). Their songs often express deep longing for God's presence.*

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| 2 | <i>My soul thirsteth for God, for the living God: when shall I come and appear before God?</i> | My soul thirsts for God, for the living God. When can I go and meet with God? |
| 3 | <i>My tears have been my meat day and night, while they continually say unto me, Where is thy God?</i> | My tears have been my food day and night, while people say to me all day long, "Where is your God?" |
| 4 | <i>When I remember these things, I pour out my soul in me: for I had gone with the multitude, I went with them to the house of God, with the voice of joy and praise, with a multitude that kept holyday.</i> | These things I remember as I pour out my soul: how I used to go to the house of God under the protection of the Mighty One with shouts of joy and praise among the festive throng. |
| 5 | <i>Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted in me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him for the help of his countenance.</i> | Why are You cast down, O my soul? And why are You disquieted within me? Hope in God, for I shall yet praise Him for the help of His countenance. |
| 6 | <i>O my God, my soul is cast down within me: therefore will I remember thee from the land of Jordan, and of the Hermonites, from the hill Mizar.</i> | My soul is downcast within me; therefore I will remember you from the land of the Jordan, the heights of Hermon — from Mount Mizar. |
| 7 | <i>Deep calleth unto deep at the noise of thy waterspouts: all thy waves and thy billows are gone over me.</i> | Deep calls to deep in the roar of your waterfalls; all your waves and breakers have swept over me. |
| 8 | <i>Yet the LORD will command his lovingkindness in the daytime, and in the night his song shall be with me, and my prayer unto the God of my life.</i> | Yet the LORD will command His lovingkindness in the daytime, and in the night His song shall be with me, and my prayer to the God of my life. |

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| <p>9 <i>I will say unto God my rock, Why hast thou forgotten me? why go I mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?</i></p> <p>10 <i>As with a sword in my bones, mine enemies reproach me; while they say daily unto me, Where is thy God?</i></p> <p>11 <i>Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.</i></p> | <p>I say to God my Rock, "Why have You forgotten me? Why must I go about mourning, oppressed by the enemy?"</p> <p>My bones suffer mortal agony as my foes taunt me, saying to me all day long, "Where is Your God?"</p> <p>Why are You cast down, O my soul? And why are You disquieted within me? Hope in God, for I shall yet praise Him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 63:1-2; Ps 143:6-7; Ps 119:131; Isa 26:8-9; Ps 84:1-2
- v2 — Ps 63:1; Ps 84:10; John 7:37; Ps 27:4; Rev 22:1
- v3 — Ps 79:10; Ps 115:2; Joel 2:17; Ps 42:10; Ps 80:5
- v4 — Isa 30:29
- v5 — Ps 37:7; Heb 10:36-37; Ps 61:2; Matt 1:23; Ps 27:13-14
- v6 — Ps 61:2; Jonah 2:7; Deut 3:8-9; Ps 43:4; 2 Sam 17:22
- v7 — Jonah 2:3; Ps 69:14-15; Ps 88:7; Lam 3:53-55
- v8 — Ps 16:7; Ps 149:5; Ps 63:6; Job 35:10; Deut 28:8
- v9 — Ps 38:6
- v10 — Ps 42:3
- v11 — Ps 42:5; Jer 33:6; Jer 30:17; Ps 43:5

Psalm 43

The psalmist pleads with God to judge his cause against an ungodly nation and send out His light and truth to lead him to the holy hill. He again commands his own soul to hope in God, for he shall yet praise the LORD, the health of his countenance.

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| <p>1 <i>Judge me, O God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation: O deliver me from the deceitful and unjust man.</i></p> | <p>Vindicate me, my God, and plead my cause against an unfaithful nation. Rescue me from those who are deceitful and wicked.</p> |
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2	<i>For thou art the God of my strength: why dost thou cast me off? why go I mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?</i>	You are God my stronghold. Why have You rejected me? Why must I go about mourning, oppressed by the enemy?
3	<i>O send out thy light and thy truth: let them lead me; let them bring me unto thy holy hill, and to thy tabernacles.</i>	Send me Your light and Your faithful care, let them lead me; let them bring me to Your holy mountain, to the place where You dwell.
4	<i>Then will I go unto the altar of God, unto God my exceeding joy: yea, upon the harp will I praise thee, O God my God.</i>	Then I will go to the altar of God, to God, my joy and my delight. I will praise You with the lyre, O God, my God.
5	<i>Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.</i>	Why are You cast down, O my soul? And why are You disquieted within me? Hope in God, for I shall yet praise Him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 35:1; Ps 7:8; Ps 26:1; 1 Sam 24:15; Ps 35:24
- v2 — Ps 42:9; Ps 28:7; Eph 6:10; Ps 94:14; Isa 40:31
- v3 — Ps 36:9; Prov 3:5-6; Ps 97:11; John 1:4; Ps 143:10
- v4 — Isa 61:10; Hab 3:17-18; Ps 66:13-15; Ps 57:8; Ps 71:22-23
- v5 — Ps 42:5; Ps 42:11

Psalm 44

To the chief Musician for the Sons of Korah. Maschil.

The people recall how God drove out nations for their fathers, yet now He has cast them off and scattered them among the heathen. They protest their faithfulness, declaring that they are killed all the day long and counted as sheep for the slaughter, and plead with God to awake and redeem them.

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| 1 <i>We have heard with our ears, O God,
our fathers have told us, what work
thou didst in their days, in the times of
old.</i> | We have heard with our ears, O God;
our fathers have told us what work
You did in their days, in the times of
old. |
| 2 <i>How thou didst drive out the heathen
with thy hand, and plantedst them;
how thou didst afflict the people, and
cast them out.</i> | How you drove out the heathen with
your hand, and planted them; how you
afflicted the people, and cast them out. |
| 3 <i>For they got not the land in
possession by their own sword,
neither did their own arm save them:
but thy right hand, and thine arm, and
the light of thy countenance, because
thou hadst a favour unto them.</i> | They did not get the land in possession
by their own sword, nor did their own
arm save them; but your right hand,
and your arm, and the light of your
countenance, because you had a favor
to them. |
| 4 <i>Thou art my King, O God: command
deliverances for Jacob.</i> | You are my King and my God, Who
decrees victories for Jacob. |
| 5 <i>Through thee will we push down our
enemies: through thy name will we
tread them under that rise up against
us.</i> | Through you we push back our
enemies; through your name we
trample our foes. |
| 6 <i>For I will not trust in my bow, neither
shall my sword save me.</i> | I put no trust in my bow, my sword
does not bring me victory; |
| 7 <i>But thou hast saved us from our
enemies, and hast put them to shame
that hated us.</i> | but you give us victory over our
enemies, you put our adversaries to
shame. |
| 8 <i>In God we boast all the day long, and
praise thy name for ever. Selah.</i> | In God we make our boast all day long.
We will praise your name forever. |
| 9 <i>But thou hast cast off, and put us to
shame; and goest not forth with our
armies.</i> | But now you have rejected and
humbled us; you no longer go out with
our armies. |
| 10 <i>Thou makest us to turn back from the
enemy: and they which hate us spoil
for themselves.</i> | You made us retreat before the enemy,
and our adversaries have plundered us. |

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| 11 <i>Thou hast given us like sheep appointed for meat; and hast scattered us among the heathen.</i> | You gave us up to be devoured like sheep and have scattered us among the nations. |
| 12 <i>Thou sellest thy people for nought, and dost not increase thy wealth by their price.</i> | You sold your people for a pittance, gaining nothing from their sale. |
| 13 <i>Thou makest us a reproach to our neighbours, a scorn and a derision to them that are round about us.</i> | You have made us a reproach to our neighbors, the scorn and derision of those around us. |
| 14 <i>Thou makest us a byword among the heathen, a shaking of the head among the people.</i> | You have made us a byword among the nations; the peoples shake their heads at us. |
| 15 <i>My confusion is continually before me, and the shame of my face hath covered me,</i> | I live in disgrace all day long, and my face is covered with shame |
| 16 <i>For the voice of him that reproacheth and blasphemeth; by reason of the enemy and avenger.</i> | at the taunts of those who reproach and revile me, because of the enemy, who is bent on revenge. |
| 17 <i>All this is come upon us; yet have we not forgotten thee, neither have we dealt falsely in thy covenant.</i> | All this came upon us, though we had not forgotten you; we had not been false to your covenant. |
| 18 <i>Our heart is not turned back, neither have our steps declined from thy way;</i> | Our hearts had not turned back; our feet had not strayed from your path. |
| 19 <i>Though thou hast sore broken us in the place of dragons, and covered us with the shadow of death.</i> | But you crushed us and made us a haunt for jackals; you covered us over with deep darkness. |
| 20 <i>If we have forgotten the name of our God, or stretched out our hands to a strange god;</i> | If we had forgotten the name of our God or spread out our hands to a foreign god, |
| 21 <i>Shall not God search this out? for he knoweth the secrets of the heart.</i> | would not God have discovered it, since He knows the secrets of the heart? |

22	<i>Yea, for thy sake are we killed all the day long; we are counted as sheep for the slaughter.</i>	Yet for your sake we face death all day long; we are considered as sheep to be slaughtered.
23	<i>Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord? arise, cast us not off for ever.</i>	Awake, Lord! Why do you sleep? Rouse yourself! Do not reject us forever.
24	<i>Wherefore hidest thou thy face, and forgettest our affliction and our oppression?</i>	Why do you hide your face and forget our misery and oppression?
25	<i>For our soul is bowed down to the dust: our belly cleaveth unto the earth.</i>	We are brought down to the dust; our bodies cling to the ground.
26	<i>Rise up for our help, and redeem us for thy mercies' sake.</i>	Rise up and help us; rescue us because of your mercy.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 78:3-6; Ex 13:14-15; Judg 6:13; Joel 1:3; Deut 6:20
- v2 — Ex 15:17; Ps 78:55
- v3 — Deut 7:7-8; Deut 8:17-18; Josh 24:12; 2 Cor 4:7; Zech 4:6
- v4 — Ps 42:8; Ps 74:12
- v5 — Ps 108:13; Ps 60:12; Ps 118:10-13; Phil 4:13; Deut 33:17
- v6 — Ps 20:7; 1 Sam 17:47; Hos 1:7; Ps 33:16-17
- v8 — Ps 34:2; Jer 9:24; 1 Cor 1:29-31; Rom 2:17
- v9 — Ps 74:1; Ps 60:10; Ps 108:11; Ps 60:1; Ps 43:2
- v18 — Ps 119:51; Ps 119:157; Job 23:11-12; Ps 78:57; Zeph 1:6
- v21 — Jer 17:10; Jer 23:24; Job 34:21-22; Eccl 12:14; Heb 4:12-13
- v22 — Rom 8:36; Isa 53:7; Ps 44:11
- v26 — Ps 130:7-8; Ps 25:22; Ps 35:2; Ps 26:11

Psalm 45

To the chief Musician upon Shoshannim, for the Sons of Korah. Maschil. A Song of loves.

The psalmist celebrates a royal wedding, praising the king as fairer than the children of men and declaring his throne eternal. The queen stands in gold of Ophir, and the psalm promises that the king's name shall be remembered in all generations.

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| 1 <i>My heart is inditing a good matter: I speak of the things which I have made touching the king: my tongue is the pen of a ready writer.</i> | My heart is stirred by a noble theme as I recite my verses for the king; my tongue is the pen of a skillful writer. |
| 2 <i>Thou art fairer than the children of men: grace is poured into thy lips: therefore God hath blessed thee for ever.</i> | You are the most excellent of men and your lips have been anointed with grace, since God has blessed you forever. |
| 3 <i>Gird thy sword upon thy thigh, O most mighty, with thy glory and thy majesty.</i> | Gird your sword on your side, you mighty one; clothe yourself with splendor and majesty. |
| 4 <i>And in thy majesty ride prosperously because of truth and meekness and righteousness; and thy right hand shall teach thee terrible things.</i> | In your majesty ride forth victoriously in the cause of truth, humility and justice; let your right hand achieve awesome deeds. |
| 5 <i>Thine arrows are sharp in the heart of the king's enemies; whereby the people fall under thee.</i> | Let your sharp arrows pierce the hearts of the king's enemies; let the nations fall beneath your feet. |
| 6 <i>Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre.</i> | Your throne, O God, will last for ever and ever; a scepter of justice will be the scepter of Your kingdom. |
| 7 <i>Thou lovest righteousness, and hatest wickedness: therefore God, thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.</i> | You love righteousness and hate wickedness; therefore God, Your God, has set You above Your companions by anointing You with the oil of joy. |
| 8 <i>All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia, out of the ivory palaces, whereby they have made thee glad.</i> | All your robes are fragrant with myrrh and aloes and cassia; from palaces adorned with ivory the music of the strings makes you glad. |
| 9 <i>Kings' daughters were among thy honourable women: upon thy right hand did stand the queen in gold of Ophir.</i> | Daughters of kings are among your honored women; at your right hand is the royal bride in gold of Ophir. |

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| 10 <i>Hearken, O daughter, and consider, and incline thine ear; forget also thine own people, and thy father's house;</i> | Listen, daughter, and pay careful attention: forget your people and your father's house. |
| 11 <i>So shall the king greatly desire thy beauty: for he is thy Lord; and worship thou him.</i> | Let the king be enthralled by your beauty; honor him, for he is your lord. |
| 12 <i>And the daughter of Tyre shall be there with a gift; even the rich among the people shall intreat thy favour.</i> | The city of Tyre will come with a gift, people of wealth will seek your favor. |
| 13 <i>The king's daughter is all glorious within: her clothing is of wrought gold.</i> | All glorious is the princess within her chamber; her gown is interwoven with gold. |
| 14 <i>She shall be brought unto the king in raiment of needlework: the virgins her companions that follow her shall be brought unto thee.</i> | In embroidered garments she is led to the king; her virgin companions follow her — those brought to be with her. |
| 15 <i>With gladness and rejoicing shall they be brought: they shall enter into the king's palace.</i> | Led in with joy and gladness, they enter the palace of the king. |
| 16 <i>Instead of thy fathers shall be thy children, whom thou mayest make princes in all the earth.</i> | Your sons will take the place of your fathers; you will make them princes throughout the land. |
| 17 <i>I will make thy name to be remembered in all generations: therefore shall the people praise thee for ever and ever.</i> | I will perpetuate your memory through all generations; therefore the nations will praise you for ever and ever. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 49:3; 2 Sam 23:2; Job 33:3; Prov 16:23; Job 32:18-20
v2 — Luke 4:22; Song 5:10-16; John 7:46; Ps 21:6; Heb 7:26
v5 — Ps 21:12; Num 24:8; Ps 38:2
v6 — Heb 1:8-9; Ps 93:2; John 1:1; Isa 9:6-7; Jer 33:15-16
v7 — Heb 1:9; Ps 21:6; Isa 61:1-3; Ps 33:5; Eph 1:3
v8 — Song 1:3; 2 Cor 2:14-16; John 19:39

v9 — Rev 21:9; 1 Kgs 2:19; Eph 5:26-27; Rev 21:2; Rev 19:7
v10 — Song 2:10-13; Gen 12:1; Matt 10:37; Matt 19:29; 2 Cor 6:17-7:1
v11 — Ps 95:6; Isa 54:5; Song 4:1-5; Zeph 3:17; Phil 2:10-11
v12 — Ps 22:29; Isa 60:3; Isa 49:23
v13 — Rev 19:7-8; Isa 61:10; Matt 5:16; Luke 11:40; Rom 3:22
v17 — Mal 1:11; Isa 62:3; Ps 72:17-19; Isa 61:9

Psalm 46

To the chief Musician for the Sons of Korah. A Song upon Alamoth.

The psalmist declares God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. Though the earth be removed and mountains fall into the sea, God dwells in the midst of His city and commands: "Be still, and know that I am God."

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| 1 | <i>God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble.</i> | God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. |
| 2 | <i>Therefore will not we fear, though the earth be removed, and though the mountains be carried into the midst of the sea;</i> | Therefore we will not fear, though the earth give way and the mountains fall into the heart of the sea, |
| 3 | <i>Though the waters thereof roar and be troubled, though the mountains shake with the swelling thereof. Selah.</i> | though its waters roar and foam and the mountains quake with their surging. |
| 4 | <i>There is a river, the streams whereof shall make glad the city of God, the holy place of the tabernacles of the most High.</i> | There is a river, the streams of which shall make glad the city of God, the holy place of the tabernacles of the Most High. |
| 5 | <i>God is in the midst of her; she shall not be moved: God shall help her, and that right early.</i> | God is within her, she will not fall; God will help her at break of day. |
| 6 | <i>The heathen raged, the kingdoms were moved: he uttered his voice, the earth melted.</i> | Nations are in uproar, kingdoms fall; He lifts His voice, the earth melts. |
| 7 | <i>The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.</i> | The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah. |

8	<i>Come, behold the works of the LORD, what desolations he hath made in the earth.</i>	Come, see the works of the LORD, the desolations He has made in the earth.
9	<i>He maketh wars to cease unto the end of the earth; he breaketh the bow, and cutteth the spear in sunder; he burneth the chariot in the fire.</i>	He makes wars to cease to the end of the earth; He breaks the bow and cuts the spear in pieces; He burns the chariot in the fire.
10	<i>Be still, and know that I am God: I will be exalted among the heathen, I will be exalted in the earth.</i>	"Be still, and know that I am God; I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth."
11	<i>The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.</i>	The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 145:18; Ps 9:9; Prov 18:10; Ps 62:7-8; Ps 91:1-9
- v2 — Ps 23:4; Heb 13:6; Ps 27:3; Luke 21:9-11; Matt 21:21
- v3 — Jer 5:22; Ps 93:3-4; Job 9:5-6; Mic 1:4; Judg 5:4-5
- v4 — Rev 22:1-3; Ezek 47:1-12; Ps 36:8-9; Ps 87:3; Ps 48:8
- v5 — Zech 2:5; Joel 2:27; Zeph 3:15; Zech 2:10-11; Ezek 43:7
- v6 — Amos 9:5; Ps 18:13; Mic 1:4; Hab 3:5-6; Nah 1:5
- v7 — Ps 9:9; Rom 8:31; Num 14:9; 2 Chr 13:12; Matt 28:20
- v8 — Ps 66:5; Isa 24:1; Isa 61:4; Ps 92:4-6; Isa 34:2-17
- v9 — Isa 2:4; Mic 4:3-4; Mic 5:10; Josh 11:9; Isa 60:18
- v10 — Ps 100:3; Hab 2:20; Ezek 38:23; Zech 2:13; Ps 83:18
- v11 — Jer 16:19; Deut 33:27; Ps 46:7; Ps 48:3; Ps 46:1

Psalm 47

To the chief Musician. A Psalm for the Sons of Korah.

The psalmist calls all nations to clap their hands and shout to God, for the LORD Most High is a great King over all the earth. God has ascended with a shout and the sound of a trumpet; He reigns over the nations and sits on His holy throne.

1	<i>O clap your hands, all ye people; shout unto God with the voice of triumph.</i>	Clap Your hands, all You nations; shout to God with cries of joy.
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| <p>2 <i>For the LORD most high is terrible;
he is a great King over all the earth.</i></p> <p>3 <i>He shall subdue the people under us,
and the nations under our feet.</i></p> <p>4 <i>He shall choose our inheritance for
us, the excellency of Jacob whom he
loved. Selah.</i></p> <p>5 <i>God is gone up with a shout, the
LORD with the sound of a trumpet.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Sing praises to God, sing praises:
sing praises unto our King, sing
praises.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For God is the King of all the earth:
sing ye praises with understanding.</i></p> <p>8 <i>God reigneth over the heathen: God
sitteth upon the throne of his holiness.</i></p> <p>9 <i>The princes of the people are
gathered together, even the people of
the God of Abraham: for the shields of
the earth belong unto God: he is
greatly exalted.</i></p> | <p>For the LORD Most High is awesome,
the great King over all the earth.</p> <p>He subdued nations under us, peoples
under our feet.</p> <p>He chose our inheritance for us, the
pride of Jacob, whom he loved.</p> <p>God has ascended amid shouts of joy,
the LORD amid the sounding of
trumpets.</p> <p>Sing praises to God, sing praises; sing
praises to our King, sing praises.</p> <p>For God is the King of all the earth;
sing to him a psalm of praise.</p> <p>God reigns over the nations; God is
seated on His holy throne.</p> <p>The nobles of the nations assemble as
the people of the God of Abraham, for
the kings of the earth belong to God;
He is greatly exalted.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 98:4; Ps 106:47; Jer 31:7; Ps 46:1; Rev 19:1-2
- v2 — Ps 99:3; Ps 95:3; Mal 1:14; Ps 68:35; Deut 7:21
- v3 — 1 Cor 15:25
- v4 — 1 Pet 1:4; Amos 6:8; Nah 2:2
- v5 — Ps 68:33; 1 Cor 15:52; 1 Thess 4:16; Ps 24:7-10
- v6 — Isa 12:4-6; Matt 25:34; Ps 117:1-2; Ps 68:4; Ps 145:1
- v7 — Zech 14:9; Col 3:16
- v8 — 1 Chr 16:31; Rev 19:6
- v9 — Ps 89:18; Gen 49:10; Ps 72:7-9; Gen 17:7-8; Ex 3:6

Psalm 48

A Song and Psalm for the Sons of Korah.

The psalmist praises the greatness of the LORD in the city of our God. Mount Zion, beautiful for situation, is the joy of the whole earth; when kings see her they marvel and flee. The psalm calls God's people to walk about Zion and count her towers.

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| 1 | <i>Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised in the city of our God, in the mountain of his holiness.</i> | Great is the LORD, and most worthy of praise, in the city of our God, His holy mountain. |
| 2 | <i>Beautiful for situation, the joy of the whole earth, is mount Zion, on the sides of the north, the city of the great King.</i> | Beautiful in its loftiness, the joy of the whole earth, like the heights of Zaphon is Mount Zion, the city of the Great King. |
| 3 | <i>God is known in her palaces for a refuge.</i> | God is in her citadels; He has shown Himself to be her fortress. |
| 4 | <i>For, lo, the kings were assembled, they passed by together.</i> | When the kings joined forces, when they advanced together, |
| 5 | <i>They saw it, and so they marvelled; they were troubled, and hasted away.</i> | they saw her and were astounded; they fled in terror. |
| 6 | <i>Fear took hold upon them there, and pain, as of a woman in travail.</i> | Trembling seized them there, pain like that of a woman in labor. |
| 7 | <i>Thou breakest the ships of Tarshish with an east wind.</i> | You destroyed them like ships of Tarshish shattered by an east wind. |
| 8 | <i>As we have heard, so have we seen in the city of the LORD of hosts, in the city of our God: God will establish it for ever. Selah.</i> | As we have heard, so have we seen in the city of the LORD of hosts, in the city of our God; God will establish it forever. Selah. |
| 9 | <i>We have thought of thy lovingkindness, O God, in the midst of thy temple.</i> | We have thought of Your lovingkindness, O God, in the midst of Your temple. |
| 10 | <i>According to thy name, O God, so is thy praise unto the ends of the earth: thy right hand is full of righteousness.</i> | Like Your name, O God, Your praise reaches to the ends of the earth; Your right hand is filled with righteousness. |

11	<i>Let mount Zion rejoice, let the daughters of Judah be glad, because of thy judgments.</i>	Mount Zion rejoices, the villages of Judah are glad because of Your judgments.
12	<i>Walk about Zion, and go round about her: tell the towers thereof.</i>	Walk about Zion, go around her, count her towers,
13	<i>Mark ye well her bulwarks, consider her palaces; that ye may tell it to the generation following.</i>	consider well her ramparts, view her citadels, that You may tell of them to the next generation.
14	<i>For this God is our God for ever and ever: he will be our guide even unto death.</i>	For this God is our God for ever and ever; He will be our guide even to the end.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mic 4:1; Zech 8:3; Ps 96:4; Isa 2:2-3; Ps 46:4
- v2 — Ps 50:2; Matt 5:35; Lam 2:15; Heb 12:22
- v3 — Zech 2:4-5; Ps 125:1; Ps 46:7; Isa 37:33-36
- v7 — Jer 18:17
- v8 — Ps 87:5
- v9 — Ps 26:3; Ps 77:10-14; Ps 40:10; Ps 63:2-3; 2 Chr 20:5-13
- v10 — Ps 113:3; Mal 1:11; Deut 28:58
- v11 — Ps 97:8; Rev 18:20
- v13 — Ps 71:18; Ps 122:7
- v14 — Isa 58:11; Ps 23:3-4; Ps 73:24; Ps 25:9; John 16:13

Psalm 49

To the chief Musician. A Psalm for the Sons of Korah.

The psalmist addresses all peoples with a wisdom meditation on death and riches. No man can redeem his brother or give God a ransom for his soul; the wise and the fool alike perish and leave their wealth to others. Man that is in honour and understands not is like the beasts that perish.

1	<i>Hear this, all ye people; give ear, all ye inhabitants of the world:</i>	Hear this, all you peoples; listen, all who live in this world,
2	<i>Both low and high, rich and poor, together.</i>	both low and high, rich and poor alike:

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| 3 | <i>My mouth shall speak of wisdom; and the meditation of my heart shall be of understanding.</i> | My mouth will speak words of wisdom; the meditation of my heart will give you understanding. |
| 4 | <i>I will incline mine ear to a parable: I will open my dark saying upon the harp.</i> | I will turn my ear to a proverb; with the harp I will expound my riddle: |
| 5 | <i>Wherefore should I fear in the days of evil, when the iniquity of my heels shall compass me about?</i> | Why should I fear when evil days come, when wicked deceivers surround me — |
| 6 | <i>They that trust in their wealth, and boast themselves in the multitude of their riches;</i> | those who trust in their wealth and boast of their great riches? |
| 7 | <i>None of them can by any means redeem his brother, nor give to God a ransom for him:</i> | No one can redeem the life of another or give to God a sufficient ransom for them — |
| 8 | <i>(For the redemption of their soul is precious, and it ceaseth for ever:)</i> | the ransom for a life is costly, no payment is ever enough — |
| 9 | <i>That he should still live for ever, and not see corruption.</i> | so that they should live on forever and not see decay. |
| 10 | <i>For he seeth that wise men die, likewise the fool and the brutish person perish, and leave their wealth to others.</i> | For all can see that the wise die, that the foolish and the senseless also perish, leaving their wealth to others. |
| 11 | <i>Their inward thought is, that their houses shall continue for ever, and their dwelling places to all generations; they call their lands after their own names.</i> | Their tombs will remain their houses forever, their dwellings for endless generations, though they had named lands after themselves. |
| 12 | <i>Nevertheless man being in honour abideth not: he is like the beasts that perish.</i> | People, despite their wealth, do not endure; they are like the beasts that perish. |
| 13 | <i>This their way is their folly: yet their posterity approve their sayings. Selah.</i> | This is the fate of those who trust in themselves, and of their followers, who approve their sayings. |

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| <p>14 <i>Like sheep they are laid in the grave; death shall feed on them; and the upright shall have dominion over them in the morning; and their beauty shall consume in the grave from their dwelling.</i></p> <p>15 <i>But God will redeem my soul from the power of the grave: for he shall receive me. Selah.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Be not thou afraid when one is made rich, when the glory of his house is increased;</i></p> <p>17 <i>For when he dieth he shall carry nothing away: his glory shall not descend after him.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Though while he lived he blessed his soul: and men will praise thee, when thou doest well to thyself.</i></p> <p>19 <i>He shall go to the generation of his fathers; they shall never see light.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Man that is in honour, and understandeth not, is like the beasts that perish.</i></p> | <p>They are like sheep and are destined to die; death will be their shepherd (but the upright will prevail over them in the morning). Their forms will decay in the grave, far from their princely mansions.</p> <p>But God will redeem my soul from the power of the grave, for He shall receive me. Selah.</p> <p>Do not be overawed when others grow rich, when the splendor of their houses increases;</p> <p>for they will take nothing with them when they die, their splendor will not descend with them.</p> <p>Though while they live they count themselves blessed — and people praise you when you prosper —</p> <p>they will join those who have gone before them, who will never again see the light of life.</p> <p>People who have wealth but lack understanding are like the beasts that perish.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 78:1; Matt 11:15; Ps 33:8; Matt 28:19-20; Rev 2:17
- v2** — Ps 62:9; Jas 2:1-7
- v3** — Ps 19:14; Matt 12:35; Prov 22:20-21; Prov 22:17; Deut 32:2
- v4** — Ps 78:2; Matt 13:35
- v6** — 1 Tim 6:17; Jer 9:23; Ezek 28:4-5; Ps 52:7
- v7** — Matt 16:26; Matt 20:28; 1 Tim 2:6; 1 Pet 1:18
- v9** — Ps 89:48; Ps 16:10; Eccl 8:8
- v10** — Luke 12:20; Ps 39:6; Eccl 5:13-16; Heb 9:27; 1 Tim 6:6-10

- v11 — Gen 4:17; Ps 64:6; Ps 5:9
- v12 — Eccl 3:18-21; Ps 39:5; Ps 82:7; Ps 49:20; Eccl 9:12
- v14 — Mal 4:3; 1 Cor 6:2; Job 24:19-20; Job 30:23; Dan 7:22
- v15 — Ps 73:24; Ps 56:13; Ps 86:13; Ps 89:48; Hos 13:14

Psalm 50

A Psalm of Asaph.

God summons the earth from the rising of the sun to its setting and shines forth from Zion. He rebukes His people for trusting in sacrifice while ignoring obedience, asking whether He eats the flesh of bulls or drinks the blood of goats. He commands: offer thanksgiving and call on Me in the day of trouble.

- 1 *The mighty God, even the LORD, hath spoken, and called the earth from the rising of the sun unto the going down thereof.* The Mighty One, God, the LORD, speaks and summons the earth from the rising of the sun to where it sets.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Asaph** (AY-saf) — "gatherer" — Chief musician appointed by David; a seer and worship leader (1 Chronicles 16:4–5; 2 Chronicles 29:30). Twelve Psalms bear his name (50, 73–83). His Psalms often confront Israel with God's justice and call the people to genuine worship rather than empty ritual.

- 2 *Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God hath shined.* From Zion, perfect in beauty, God shines forth.
- 3 *Our God shall come, and shall not keep silence: a fire shall devour before him, and it shall be very tempestuous round about him.* Our God comes and will not be silent; a fire devours before Him, and around Him a tempest rages.
- 4 *He shall call to the heavens from above, and to the earth, that he may judge his people.* He summons the heavens above, and the earth, that He may judge His people:
- 5 *Gather my saints together unto me; those that have made a covenant with me by sacrifice.* "Gather to me this consecrated people, who made a covenant with me by sacrifice."
- 6 *And the heavens shall declare his righteousness: for God is judge himself. Selah.* the heavens proclaim His righteousness, for He is a God of justice.

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| 7 <i>Hear, O my people, and I will speak;
O Israel, and I will testify against
thee: I am God, even thy God.</i> | "Listen, my people. I will speak; I will
testify against You, Israel: I am God,
Your God. |
| 8 <i>I will not reprove thee for thy
sacrifices or thy burnt offerings, to
have been continually before me.</i> | I bring no charges against You
concerning Your sacrifices or
concerning Your burnt offerings,
which are ever before me. |
| 9 <i>I will take no bullock out of thy house,
nor he goats out of thy folds.</i> | I have no need of a bull from Your
stall or of goats from Your pens, |
| 10 <i>For every beast of the forest is mine,
and the cattle upon a thousand hills.</i> | for every animal of the forest is mine,
and the cattle on a thousand hills. |
| 11 <i>I know all the fowls of the mountains:
and the wild beasts of the field are
mine.</i> | I know every bird in the mountains,
and the insects in the fields are mine. |
| 12 <i>If I were hungry, I would not tell thee:
for the world is mine, and the fulness
thereof.</i> | If I were hungry I would not tell You,
for the world is mine. All that is in it. |
| 13 <i>Will I eat the flesh of bulls, or drink
the blood of goats?</i> | Do I eat the flesh of bulls or drink the
blood of goats? |
| 14 <i>Offer unto God thanksgiving; and pay
thy vows unto the most High:</i> | Sacrifice thank offerings to God, fulfill
Your vows to the Most High, |
| 15 <i>And call upon me in the day of
trouble: I will deliver thee, and thou
shalt glorify me.</i> | call on me in the day of trouble; I will
deliver You, and You will honor me." |
| 16 <i>But unto the wicked God saith, What
hast thou to do to declare my statutes,
or that thou shouldest take my
covenant in thy mouth?</i> | But to the wicked person, God says:
"What right have you to recite my laws
or take my covenant on your lips? |
| 17 <i>Seeing thou hatest instruction, and
castest my words behind thee.</i> | You hate my instruction and cast my
words behind you. |
| 18 <i>When thou sawest a thief, then thou
consentedst with him, and hast been
partaker with adulterers.</i> | When you see a thief, you join with
him; you throw in your lot with
adulterers. |

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| 19 <i>Thou givest thy mouth to evil, and thy tongue frameth deceit.</i> | You use your mouth for evil and harness your tongue to deceit. |
| 20 <i>Thou sittest and speakest against thy brother; thou slanderest thine own mother's son.</i> | You sit and testify against your brother and slander your own mother's son. |
| 21 <i>These things hast thou done, and I kept silence; thou thoughtest that I was altogether such an one as thyself; but I will reprove thee, and set them in order before thine eyes.</i> | When you did these things and I kept silent, you thought I was exactly like you. But I now arraign you and set my accusations before you. |
| 22 <i>Now consider this, ye that forget God, lest I tear you in pieces, and there be none to deliver.</i> | Consider this, You who forget God, or I will tear You to pieces, with no one to rescue you: |
| 23 <i>Whoso offereth praise glorifieth me: and to him that ordereth his conversation aright will I shew the salvation of God.</i> | Those who sacrifice thank offerings honor me, and to the blameless I will show my salvation." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 113:3; Matt 25:32; Josh 22:22; Amos 3:8; Jer 32:18-19
v2 — Ps 48:2; Rev 21:23; Ps 80:1; Rev 1:16; Deut 33:2
v5 — Heb 13:20; Ex 24:3-8; Matt 26:28; Heb 12:24; Deut 33:2-3
v6 — Ps 97:6; Ps 75:7; Ps 89:5; Rev 19:2; Rom 14:9-12
v8 — Heb 10:4-10; Hos 6:6; Isa 1:11-31; Ps 51:16; Ps 40:6-8
v12 — Ex 19:5; Ps 24:1-2; Deut 10:14; 1 Cor 10:26-28; Job 41:11
v14 — Heb 13:15; Ps 56:12; Deut 23:21; Ps 107:21-22; Ps 116:12-14
v15 — Ps 107:28; Ps 91:15; Ps 34:3-4; Zech 13:9; Ps 107:19
v17 — Neh 9:26; 2 Tim 4:3-4; Prov 12:1; Prov 1:28-29; 1 Kgs 14:9
v21 — Rom 2:4-5; Isa 57:11; Prov 29:1; Eccl 12:14; Ps 94:7-11
v22 — Job 8:13; Ps 9:17; Hos 4:6; Ps 7:2; Deut 32:18
v23 — Ps 91:16; Ps 24:4-5; Jas 3:13; Ps 50:14-15; Rom 12:1

Psalm 51

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David, when Nathan the prophet came to him, after he had gone in to Bathsheba.

The psalmist confesses his sin against God and pleads for mercy according to the LORD's lovingkindness. He cries, "Create in me a clean heart, O God," and asks not to be cast from God's presence or to have the Holy Spirit taken from him. The sacrifice God desires is a broken and contrite heart.

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| 1 | <i>Have mercy upon me, O God,
according to thy lovingkindness:
according unto the multitude of thy
tender mercies blot out my
transgressions.</i> | Have mercy on me, O God, according
to Your lovingkindness; according to
the multitude of Your tender mercies
blot out my transgressions. |
| 2 | <i>Wash me thoroughly from mine
iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin.</i> | Wash away all my iniquity and cleanse
me from my sin. |
| 3 | <i>For I acknowledge my transgressions:
and my sin is ever before me.</i> | For I know my transgressions, and my
sin is always before me. |
| 4 | <i>Against thee, thee only, have I sinned,
and done this evil in thy sight: that
thou mightest be justified when thou
speakest, and be clear when thou
judgest.</i> | Against You, You only, have I sinned
and done what is evil in Your sight; so
You are right in Your verdict and
justified when You judge. |
| 5 | <i>Behold, I was shapen in iniquity; and
in sin did my mother conceive me.</i> | Surely I was sinful at birth, sinful from
the time my mother conceived me. |
| 6 | <i>Behold, thou desirest truth in the
inward parts: and in the hidden part
thou shalt make me to know wisdom.</i> | Yet You desired faithfulness even in
the womb; You taught me wisdom in
that secret place. |
| 7 | <i>Purge me with hyssop, and I shall be
clean: wash me, and I shall be whiter
than snow.</i> | Cleanse me with hyssop. I will be
clean; wash me. I will be whiter than
snow. |
| 8 | <i>Make me to hear joy and gladness;
that the bones which thou hast broken
may rejoice.</i> | Let me hear joy and gladness; let the
bones You have crushed rejoice. |
| 9 | <i>Hide thy face from my sins, and blot
out all mine iniquities.</i> | Hide Your face from my sins and blot
out all my iniquity. |
| 10 | <i>Create in me a clean heart, O God;
and renew a right spirit within me.</i> | Create in me a clean heart, O God, and
renew a right spirit within me. |

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| <p>11 <i>Cast me not away from thy presence; and take not thy holy spirit from me.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation; and uphold me with thy free spirit.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Then will I teach transgressors thy ways; and sinners shall be converted unto thee.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Deliver me from bloodguiltiness, O God, thou God of my salvation: and my tongue shall sing aloud of thy righteousness.</i></p> <p>15 <i>O Lord, open thou my lips; and my mouth shall shew forth thy praise.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For thou desirest not sacrifice; else would I give it: thou delightest not in burnt offering.</i></p> <p>17 <i>The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit: a broken and a contrite heart, O God, thou wilt not despise.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Do good in thy good pleasure unto Zion: build thou the walls of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Then shalt thou be pleased with the sacrifices of righteousness, with burnt offering and whole burnt offering: then shall they offer bullocks upon thine altar.</i></p> | <p>Do not cast me from Your presence or take Your Holy Spirit from me.</p> <p>Restore to me the joy of Your salvation and grant me a willing spirit, to sustain me.</p> <p>Then I will teach transgressors Your ways, so that sinners will turn back to You.</p> <p>Deliver me from the guilt of bloodshed, O God, You who are God my Savior, and my tongue will sing of Your righteousness.</p> <p>Open my lips, Lord, and my mouth will declare Your praise.</p> <p>You do not delight in sacrifice, or I would bring it; You do not take pleasure in burnt offerings.</p> <p>My sacrifice, O God, is a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart You, God, will not despise.</p> <p>May it please You to prosper Zion, to build up the walls of Jerusalem.</p> <p>Then You will delight in the sacrifices of the righteous, in burnt offerings offered whole; then bulls will be offered on Your altar.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 3:19; Isa 44:22; Isa 43:25; Ps 51:9; Col 2:14
- v2 — 1 John 1:7-9; Heb 10:21-22; Ezek 36:25; Ps 51:7; Jer 4:14
- v3 — Prov 28:13; Isa 59:12; Ps 38:18; Ps 32:5; Lev 26:40-41

v5 — Rom 5:12; Job 14:4; Ps 58:3; Job 15:14-16; Eph 2:3
v6 — 1 Sam 16:7; Ps 15:2; Rom 7:22; 1 Pet 3:4; Job 38:36
v7 — 1 John 1:7; Isa 1:18; Heb 9:13-14; Num 19:18-20; Heb 9:19
v8 — Job 5:17-18; Hos 6:1-2; Matt 5:4; Ps 6:2-3; Ps 119:81-82
v10 — Ezek 11:19; 2 Cor 5:17; Eph 4:22-24; Matt 5:8; Ezek 18:31
v11 — Eph 4:30; 2 Kgs 13:23; Isa 63:10-11; Rom 8:9; Gen 6:3
v12 — Isa 41:10; Ps 13:5; Isa 61:10; Jude 1:24; 2 Cor 3:17
v16 — Hos 6:6; Ps 40:6; Heb 10:5-6; 1 Sam 15:22; Ps 51:6
v17 — Ps 34:18; Isa 66:2; Ps 147:3; Luke 15:10; Mark 12:33

Psalm 52

To the chief Musician. Maschil. A Psalm of David, when Doeg the Edomite came and told Saul, and said to him, David is come to the house of Ahimelech.

The psalmist rebukes a mighty man who boasts in evil, whose tongue is like a sharp razor. God will uproot him from the land of the living, and the righteous will see it and laugh. The psalmist trusts in the mercy of God forever and ever.

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| 1 | <i>Why boastest thou thyself in mischief, O mighty man? the goodness of God endureth continually.</i> | Why do you boast of evil, you mighty hero? Why do you boast all day long, you who are a disgrace in the eyes of God? |
| 2 | <i>Thy tongue deviseth mischiefs; like a sharp razor, working deceitfully.</i> | You who practice deceit, your tongue plots destruction; it is like a sharpened razor. |
| 3 | <i>Thou lovest evil more than good; and lying rather than to speak righteousness. Selah.</i> | You love evil rather than good, falsehood rather than speaking the truth. |
| 4 | <i>Thou lovest all devouring words, O thou deceitful tongue.</i> | You love every harmful word, you deceitful tongue! |
| 5 | <i>God shall likewise destroy thee for ever, he shall take thee away, and pluck thee out of thy dwelling place, and root thee out of the land of the living. Selah.</i> | Surely God will bring you down to everlasting ruin: He will snatch you up and pluck you from your tent; He will uproot you from the land of the living. |
| 6 | <i>The righteous also shall see, and fear, and shall laugh at him:</i> | The righteous will see and fear; they will laugh at you, saying, |

- 7

Lo, this is the man that made not God his strength; but trusted in the abundance of his riches, and strengthened himself in his wickedness.

"Here now is the man who did not make God His stronghold but trusted in His great wealth and grew strong by destroying others!"
- 8

But I am like a green olive tree in the house of God: I trust in the mercy of God for ever and ever.

But I am like a green olive tree in the house of God; I trust in the mercy of God for ever and ever.
- 9

I will praise thee for ever, because thou hast done it: and I will wait on thy name; for it is good before thy saints.

I will praise you forever, because you have done it; and I will wait on your name, for it is good, before your saints.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 103:17; Ps 107:1; Ps 94:4; 1 Sam 21:7; Prov 6:14
- v2 — Prov 18:21; Prov 6:16-19
- v3 — Jer 9:3-5; John 8:44; 2 Tim 3:4
- v4 — Ps 120:3; Jas 3:6-9
- v5 — Prov 2:22; Ps 27:13
- v6 — Job 22:19; Ps 40:3
- v7 — Jer 17:5; Eccl 8:8; Ps 73:18-20; Ps 49:6-20
- v8 — Ps 92:12-14; Hos 14:6-8; Ps 1:3; Ps 13:5; Jer 11:16
- v9 — Lam 3:25-26; Ps 130:5-6; Ps 73:28; Ps 54:6; Ps 73:25-26

Psalm 53

To the chief Musician upon Mahalath. Maschil. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist repeats the charge that the fool denies God and that all have turned aside -- there is none that does good, not even one. God has scattered the bones of those who encamp against His people, and the psalm longs for salvation to come out of Zion.

- 1

The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. Corrupt are they, and have done abominable iniquity: there is none that doeth good.

The fool says in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt. Their ways are vile; there is no one who does good.

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| <p>2 <i>God looked down from heaven upon the children of men, to see if there were any that did understand, that did seek God.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Every one of them is gone back: they are altogether become filthy; there is none that doeth good, no, not one.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Have the workers of iniquity no knowledge? who eat up my people as they eat bread: they have not called upon God.</i></p> <p>5 <i>There were they in great fear, where no fear was: for God hath scattered the bones of him that encampeth against thee: thou hast put them to shame, because God hath despised them.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Oh that the salvation of Israel were come out of Zion! When God bringeth back the captivity of his people, Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.</i></p> | <p>God looks down from heaven on all mankind to see if there are any who understand, any who seek God.</p> <p>Everyone has turned away, all have become corrupt; there is no one who does good, not even one.</p> <p>Do all these evildoers know nothing? They devour my people as though eating bread; they never call on God.</p> <p>But there they were, overwhelmed with dread, where there was nothing to dread. God scattered the bones of those who attacked you; you put them to shame, for God despised them.</p> <p>Oh, that salvation for Israel would come out of Zion! When God restores His people, let Jacob rejoice and Israel be glad!</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 14:1-7; Ps 10:4
v2 — Isa 55:6; 2 Chr 15:2; Jer 16:17; Ps 27:8; 2 Chr 19:3
v3 — Rom 3:12; Isa 64:6; Ps 14:3; Isa 53:6; Jer 8:5-6
v4 — Jer 4:22; Jer 10:25
v5 — Prov 28:1; Lev 26:36; Ps 141:7; Jer 6:30; Ezek 6:5
v6 — Ps 14:7; Jer 30:18; Isa 12:6

Psalm 54

To the chief Musician on Neginoth. Maschil. A Psalm of David, when the Ziphims came and said to Saul, Does not David hide himself with us?

The psalmist cries for God to save him by His name when strangers rise against him and oppressors seek his soul. He trusts that God is his helper and vows to freely sacrifice and praise the LORD's name, for He has delivered him from all trouble.

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| 1 <i>Save me, O God, by thy name, and judge me by thy strength.</i> | Save me, O God, by Your name; vindicate me by Your might. |
| 2 <i>Hear my prayer, O God; give ear to the words of my mouth.</i> | Hear my prayer, O God; listen to the words of my mouth. |
| 3 <i>For strangers are risen up against me, and oppressors seek after my soul: they have not set God before them. Selah.</i> | Arrogant foes are attacking me; ruthless people are trying to kill me — people without regard for God. |
| 4 <i>Behold, God is mine helper: the Lord is with them that uphold my soul.</i> | Surely God is my help; the Lord is the one who sustains me. |
| 5 <i>He shall reward evil unto mine enemies: cut them off in thy truth.</i> | Let evil recoil on those who slander me; in Your faithfulness destroy them. |
| 6 <i>I will freely sacrifice unto thee: I will praise thy name, O LORD; for it is good.</i> | I will sacrifice a freewill offering to You; I will praise Your name, LORD, for it is good. |
| 7 <i>For he hath delivered me out of all trouble: and mine eye hath seen his desire upon mine enemies.</i> | You have delivered me from all my troubles, and my eyes have looked in triumph on my foes. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 18:10; 1 Sam 26:1; Ps 20:1; Acts 4:12; Ps 79:9
- v2 — Ps 130:2
- v3 — Ps 86:14; Ps 36:1; John 16:3; Ps 53:4
- v4 — Heb 13:6; Ps 118:6-7; Isa 41:10; Rom 8:31; Ps 118:13
- v5 — Ps 143:12; Ps 89:49
- v6 — Ps 52:9; Ps 140:13; Ps 147:1; Ps 7:17; Deut 12:6-7
- v7 — Ps 59:10; Ps 112:8; Ps 92:11; Ps 118:7; 2 Tim 4:18

Psalm 55

To the chief Musician on Neginoth. Maschil. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist is overwhelmed by terror and wishes for the wings of a dove to fly away and be at rest. He grieves that a familiar friend has betrayed him, one with whom he walked to the house of God. He casts his burden on the LORD, trusting that God will sustain him.

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| 1 Give ear to my prayer, O God; and hide not thyself from my supplication. | Listen to my prayer, O God, do not ignore my plea; |
| 2 Attend unto me, and hear me: I mourn in my complaint, and make a noise; | hear me and answer me. My thoughts trouble me and I am distraught |
| 3 Because of the voice of the enemy, because of the oppression of the wicked: for they cast iniquity upon me, and in wrath they hate me. | because of what my enemy is saying, because of the threats of the wicked; for they bring down suffering on me and assail me in their anger. |
| 4 My heart is sore pained within me: and the terrors of death are fallen upon me. | My heart is in anguish within me; the terrors of death have fallen on me. |
| 5 Fearfulness and trembling are come upon me, and horror hath overwhelmed me. | Fear and trembling have beset me; horror has overwhelmed me. |
| 6 And I said, Oh that I had wings like a dove! for then would I fly away, and be at rest. | I said, "Oh, that I had the wings of a dove! I would fly away and be at rest. |
| 7 Lo, then would I wander far off, and remain in the wilderness. Selah. | I would flee far away and stay in the desert; |
| 8 I would hasten my escape from the windy storm and tempest. | I would hurry to my place of shelter, far from the tempest and storm." |
| 9 Destroy, O Lord, and divide their tongues: for I have seen violence and strife in the city. | Lord, confuse the wicked, confound their words, for I see violence and strife in the city. |
| 10 Day and night they go about it upon the walls thereof: mischief also and sorrow are in the midst of it. | Day and night they prowl about on its walls; malice and abuse are within it. |
| 11 Wickedness is in the midst thereof: deceit and guile depart not from her streets. | Destructive forces are at work in the city; threats and lies never leave its streets. |

- 12 *For it was not an enemy that reproached me; then I could have borne it: neither was it he that hated me that did magnify himself against me; then I would have hid myself from him:* If an enemy were insulting me, I could endure it; if a foe were rising against me, I could hide.
- 13 *But it was thou, a man mine equal, my guide, and mine acquaintance.* But it is you, a man like myself, my companion, my close friend,
- 14 *We took sweet counsel together, and walked unto the house of God in company.* with whom I once enjoyed sweet fellowship at the house of God, as we walked about among the worshippers.
- 15 *Let death seize upon them, and let them go down quick into hell: for wickedness is in their dwellings, and among them.* Let death seize them, and let them go down alive into hell, for wickedness is in their dwellings, and among them.
- 16 *As for me, I will call upon God; and the LORD shall save me.* As for me, I call to God. The LORD saves me.
- 17 *Evening, and morning, and at noon, will I pray, and cry aloud: and he shall hear my voice.* Evening, morning and noon I cry out in distress. He hears my voice.
- 18 *He hath delivered my soul in peace from the battle that was against me: for there were many with me.* He rescues me unharmed from the battle waged against me, even though many oppose me.
- 19 *God shall hear, and afflict them, even he that abideth of old. Selah: because they have no changes, therefore they fear not God.* God, Who is enthroned from of old, who does not change — He will hear them and humble them, because they have no fear of God.
- 20 *He hath put forth his hands against such as be at peace with him: he hath broken his covenant.* My companion attacks His friends; He violates His covenant.
- 21 *The words of his mouth were smoother than butter, but war was in his heart: his words were softer than oil, yet were they drawn swords.* His talk is smooth as butter, yet war is in His heart; His words are more soothing than oil, yet they are drawn swords.

- 22

Cast thy burden upon the LORD, and he shall sustain thee: he shall never suffer the righteous to be moved.
- 23

But thou, O God, shalt bring them down into the pit of destruction: bloody and deceitful men shall not live out half their days; but I will trust in thee.
- Cast Your cares on the LORD and He will sustain You; He will never let the righteous be shaken.

But You, God, will bring down the wicked into the pit of decay; the bloodthirsty and deceitful will not live out half their days. But as for me, I trust in You.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 3:12; Ps 86:6; Ps 61:1; Ps 27:9; Ps 80:1
- v2 — Isa 38:14; Ps 66:19; Ps 77:3; Isa 59:11; Ps 64:1
- v6 — Rev 12:14; Ps 11:1; Ps 139:9
- v7 — Jer 9:2; Jer 37:12; 2 Sam 15:14; 2 Sam 17:21-22; Prov 6:4-5
- v12 — Ps 41:9; John 13:18; Matt 26:21-23
- v13 — Mic 7:5; 2 Sam 15:12; Jer 9:4; Mark 14:44-45
- v15 — Ps 59:13; Ps 9:17; Acts 1:18-20; Ps 109:6-20; Ps 64:7
- v17 — 1 Thess 5:17; Eph 6:18; Ps 141:2; Acts 3:1; Heb 5:7
- v18 — Ps 3:6-7; 2 Sam 22:1; Matt 26:53; 2 Chr 32:7-8; 1 John 4:4
- v19 — Deut 33:27; Zeph 1:12; Eccl 8:11; Mic 5:2; Col 1:17
- v21 — Ps 57:4; Prov 5:3-4; Prov 26:28; Ps 28:3; Ps 12:2
- v22 — 1 Pet 5:7; Ps 37:5; Phil 4:6-7; Matt 6:25; Ps 62:6

Psalm 56

To the chief Musician upon Jonathelemrechokim. Michtam of David, when the Philistines took him in Gath.

The psalmist declares that when he is afraid he will trust in God, and in God he will not fear what flesh can do to him. His enemies twist his words and watch his steps, but God records his tears in a bottle. He will walk before God in the light of the living.

- 1

Be merciful unto me, O God: for man would swallow me up; he fighting daily oppresseth me.
- 2

Mine enemies would daily swallow me up: for they be many that fight against me, O thou most High.
- Be merciful to me, my God, for my enemies are in hot pursuit; all day long they press their attack.

My adversaries pursue me all day long; in their pride many are attacking me.

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| 3 | <i>What time I am afraid, I will trust in thee.</i> | When I am afraid, I put my trust in you. |
| 4 | <i>In God I will praise his word, in God I have put my trust; I will not fear what flesh can do unto me.</i> | In God I will praise His word; in God I have put my trust; I will not fear what flesh can do to me. |
| 5 | <i>Every day they wrest my words: all their thoughts are against me for evil.</i> | All day long they twist my words; all their schemes are for my ruin. |
| 6 | <i>They gather themselves together, they hide themselves, they mark my steps, when they wait for my soul.</i> | They conspire, they lurk, they watch my steps, hoping to take my life. |
| 7 | <i>Shall they escape by iniquity? in thine anger cast down the people, O God.</i> | Because of their wickedness do not let them escape; in Your anger, God, bring the nations down. |
| 8 | <i>Thou tellest my wanderings: put thou my tears into thy bottle: are they not in thy book?</i> | Record my misery; list my tears on your scroll — are they not in your record? |
| 9 | <i>When I cry unto thee, then shall mine enemies turn back: this I know; for God is for me.</i> | Then my enemies will turn back when I call for help. By this I will know that God is for me. |
| 10 | <i>In God will I praise his word: in the LORD will I praise his word.</i> | In God, whose word I praise, in the LORD, whose word I praise — |
| 11 | <i>In God have I put my trust: I will not be afraid what man can do unto me.</i> | in God I trust and am not afraid. What can man do to me? |
| 12 | <i>Thy vows are upon me, O God: I will render praises unto thee.</i> | I am under vows to You, my God; I will present my thank offerings to You. |
| 13 | <i>For thou hast delivered my soul from death: wilt not thou deliver my feet from falling, that I may walk before God in the light of the living?</i> | For You have delivered me from death and my feet from stumbling, that I may walk before God in the light of life. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Sam 29:4; Ps 59:1; Ps 16:1; Ps 31:9; Ps 69:13-16

v2 — Ps 118:10-12
v3 — Ps 34:4; 1 Sam 30:6; 2 Cor 7:5-6; Ps 55:4-5; Ps 11:1
v4 — Heb 13:6; Ps 118:6; Rom 8:31-39; Ps 27:1; Isa 41:10
v5 — Matt 22:15; Luke 11:54; Ps 41:7; Isa 29:20-21; 2 Pet 3:16
v6 — Ps 71:10; Ps 59:3; Ps 140:2
v7 — Ps 55:23
v8 — 2 Kgs 20:5; Mal 3:16; Ps 39:12; Rev 7:17; Ps 126:5-6
v9 — Rom 8:31; Ps 118:6; Ps 102:2; Ps 118:11-13; Ps 46:11
v10 — Matt 24:35
v11 — Ps 27:1; Isa 51:12-13; Isa 51:7-8; Ps 112:7-8
v13 — Ps 116:8-9; Job 33:30; Ps 145:14; Rev 21:23-24; Ps 49:15

Psalm 57

To the chief Musician. Altaschith. Michtam of David, when he fled from Saul in the cave.

The psalmist takes refuge in the shadow of God's wings while surrounded by lions whose teeth are spears and arrows. His enemies dig a pit but fall into it themselves. His heart is fixed, and he vows to awake early and praise God among the nations.

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| 1 | <i>Be merciful unto me, O God, be merciful unto me: for my soul trusteth in thee: yea, in the shadow of thy wings will I make my refuge, until these calamities be overpast.</i> | Have mercy on me, my God, have mercy on me, for in You I take refuge. I will take refuge in the shadow of Your wings until the disaster has passed. |
| 2 | <i>I will cry unto God most high; unto God that performeth all things for me.</i> | I cry out to God Most High, to God, Who vindicates me. |
| 3 | <i>He shall send from heaven, and save me from the reproach of him that would swallow me up. Selah. God shall send forth his mercy and his truth.</i> | He shall send from heaven and save me from the reproach of him that would swallow me up. Selah. God shall send forth His mercy and His truth. |
| 4 | <i>My soul is among lions: and I lie even among them that are set on fire, even the sons of men, whose teeth are spears and arrows, and their tongue a sharp sword.</i> | I am in the midst of lions; I am forced to dwell among ravenous beasts — men whose teeth are spears and arrows, whose tongues are sharp swords. |
| 5 | <i>Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens; let thy glory be above all the earth.</i> | Be exalted, O God, above the heavens; let Your glory be over all the earth. |

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| <p>6 <i>They have prepared a net for my steps; my soul is bowed down: they have digged a pit before me, into the midst whereof they are fallen themselves. Selah.</i></p> <p>7 <i>My heart is fixed, O God, my heart is fixed: I will sing and give praise.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Awake up, my glory; awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.</i></p> <p>9 <i>I will praise thee, O Lord, among the people: I will sing unto thee among the nations.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For thy mercy is great unto the heavens: and thy truth unto the clouds.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: let thy glory be above all the earth.</i></p> | <p>They spread a net for my feet — I was bowed down in distress. They dug a pit in my path — but they have fallen into it themselves.</p> <p>My heart is fixed, O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise.</p> <p>Awake, my soul! Awake, harp and lyre! I will awaken the dawn.</p> <p>I will praise you, Lord, among the nations; I will sing of you among the peoples.</p> <p>For your mercy is great to the heavens, and your truth to the clouds.</p> <p>Be exalted, O God, above the heavens; let Your glory be over all the earth.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 91:4; Ps 17:7-8; Ps 36:7; Ps 63:7; Ps 9:10
- v2 — Ps 138:8; Phil 1:6; Heb 13:21; Isa 26:12; Ps 136:2-3
- v3 — Ps 40:11; Ps 43:3; Acts 12:11; Ps 144:5-7; Ps 61:7
- v4 — Ps 58:6; Prov 30:14; Ps 35:17; Ps 55:21
- v5 — Hab 2:14; Isa 6:3; Ps 72:19; Num 14:21; Ps 57:11
- v6 — Ps 145:14; Prov 28:10; Ps 7:15-16; Mic 7:2; Ps 35:7-8
- v7 — Ps 112:7; Eph 5:20; Ps 34:4; Ps 108:1-5; Rom 5:3
- v8 — Ps 16:9; Ps 30:12; Ps 108:1-3; Judg 5:12; Isa 52:1
- v9 — Ps 18:49; Ps 96:3; Ps 22:22-23
- v10 — Ps 108:4; Ps 36:5; Ps 103:11; Isa 54:7-10; Ps 71:19
- v11 — Ps 57:5; Ps 8:1; Rev 15:3-4

Psalm 58

To the chief Musician. Altaschith. Michtam of David.

The psalmist challenges corrupt judges who devise wickedness in their hearts and distribute violence in the earth. The wicked are like a deaf serpent that will not listen to the voice of the charmer. He calls on God to break their teeth and melt them away, that men may say there is a God that judges in the earth.

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| 1 <i>Do ye indeed speak righteousness, O congregation? do ye judge uprightly, O ye sons of men?</i> | Do you rulers indeed speak justly? Do you judge people with equity? |
| 2 <i>Yea, in heart ye work wickedness; ye weigh the violence of your hands in the earth.</i> | No, in your heart you devise injustice, and your hands mete out violence on the earth. |
| 3 <i>The wicked are estranged from the womb: they go astray as soon as they be born, speaking lies.</i> | Even from birth the wicked go astray; from the womb they are wayward, spreading lies. |
| 4 <i>Their poison is like the poison of a serpent: they are like the deaf adder that stoppeth her ear;</i> | Their venom is like the venom of a snake, like that of a cobra that has stopped its ears, |
| 5 <i>Which will not hearken to the voice of charmers, charming never so wisely.</i> | that will not heed the tune of the charmer, however skillful the enchanter may be. |
| 6 <i>Break their teeth, O God, in their mouth: break out the great teeth of the young lions, O LORD.</i> | Break the teeth in their mouths, O God; LORD, tear out the fangs of those lions! |
| 7 <i>Let them melt away as waters which run continually: when he bendeth his bow to shoot his arrows, let them be as cut in pieces.</i> | Let them vanish like water that flows away; when they draw the bow, let their arrows fall short. |
| 8 <i>As a snail which melteth, let every one of them pass away: like the untimely birth of a woman, that they may not see the sun.</i> | May they be like a slug that melts away as it moves along, like a stillborn child that never sees the sun. |
| 9 <i>Before your pots can feel the thorns, he shall take them away as with a whirlwind, both living, and in his wrath.</i> | Before your pots can feel the heat of the thorns — whether they be green or dry — the wicked will be swept away. |

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| 10 <i>The righteous shall rejoice when he seeth the vengeance: he shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked.</i> | The righteous will be glad when they are avenged, when they dip their feet in the blood of the wicked. |
| 11 <i>So that a man shall say, Verily there is a reward for the righteous: verily he is a God that judgeth in the earth.</i> | Then people will say, "Surely the righteous still are rewarded; surely there is a God Who judges the earth." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 11:3-5; Ps 57:1; Ps 72:1-4; Deut 16:18-19; Ps 82:1-2
- v2 — Ps 94:20; Isa 10:1
- v3 — Ps 51:5; Isa 48:8; Prov 22:15; Job 15:14; Eph 2:3
- v4 — Ps 140:3; Jas 3:8
- v5 — Jer 8:17
- v6 — Ps 3:7
- v7 — Josh 7:5; Ps 112:10
- v8 — Job 3:16
- v9 — Prov 10:25; Eccl 7:6; Ps 118:12
- v10 — Ps 68:23; Ps 91:8; Rev 11:17-18; Prov 11:10
- v11 — Isa 3:10; Ps 67:4; Ps 64:9; Ps 33:18; Rom 2:5

Psalm 59

To the chief Musician. Altschith. Michtam of David, when Saul sent, and they watched the house to kill him.

The psalmist pleads for deliverance from enemies who surround his house like snarling dogs. Though they lie in wait with no cause, he trusts that God will scatter them and let all Israel know that God rules in Jacob to the ends of the earth. He will sing of God's strength and mercy every morning.

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| 1 <i>Deliver me from mine enemies, O my God: defend me from them that rise up against me.</i> | Deliver me from my enemies, O God; be my fortress against those who are attacking me. |
| 2 <i>Deliver me from the workers of iniquity, and save me from bloody men.</i> | Deliver me from evildoers and save me from those who are after my blood. |

- 3 *For, lo, they lie in wait for my soul: the mighty are gathered against me; not for my transgression, nor for my sin, O LORD.* See how they lie in wait for me! Fierce men conspire against me for no offense or sin of mine, LORD.
- 4 *They run and prepare themselves without my fault: awake to help me, and behold.* I have done no wrong, yet they are ready to attack me. Arise to help me; look on my plight!
- 5 *Thou therefore, O LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, awake to visit all the heathen: be not merciful to any wicked transgressors. Selah.* You therefore, O LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, awake to visit all the heathen; be not merciful to any wicked transgressors. Selah.
- 6 *They return at evening: they make a noise like a dog, and go round about the city.* They return at evening, snarling like dogs, and prowl about the city.
- 7 *Behold, they belch out with their mouth: swords are in their lips: for who, say they, doth hear?* See what they spew from their mouths — the words from their lips are sharp as swords. They think, "Who can hear us?"
- 8 *But thou, O LORD, shalt laugh at them; thou shalt have all the heathen in derision.* But You laugh at them, LORD; You scoff at all those nations.
- 9 *Because of his strength will I wait upon thee: for God is my defence.* You are my strength, I watch for You; You, God, are my fortress,
- 10 *The God of my mercy shall prevent me: God shall let me see my desire upon mine enemies.* my God on whom I can rely. God will go before me and will let me gloat over those who slander me.
- 11 *Slay them not, lest my people forget: scatter them by thy power; and bring them down, O Lord our shield.* But do not kill them, Lord our shield, or my people will forget. In Your might uproot and bring them down.
- 12 *For the sin of their mouth and the words of their lips let them even be taken in their pride: and for cursing and lying which they speak.* For the sins of their mouths, for the words of their lips, let them be caught in their pride. For the curses and lies they utter,

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| <p>13 <i>Consume them in wrath, consume them, that they may not be: and let them know that God ruleth in Jacob unto the ends of the earth. Selah.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And at evening let them return; and let them make a noise like a dog, and go round about the city.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Let them wander up and down for meat, and grudge if they be not satisfied.</i></p> <p>16 <i>But I will sing of thy power; yea, I will sing aloud of thy mercy in the morning: for thou hast been my defence and refuge in the day of my trouble.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Unto thee, O my strength, will I sing: for God is my defence, and the God of my mercy.</i></p> | <p>consume them in your wrath, consume them till they are no more. Then it will be known to the ends of the earth that God rules over Jacob.</p> <p>They return at evening, snarling like dogs, and prowl about the city.</p> <p>They wander about for food and howl if not satisfied.</p> <p>But I will sing of your power; yes, I will sing aloud of your mercy in the morning, for you have been my defense and refuge in the day of my trouble.</p> <p>To You, O my strength, will I sing; for God is my defense, and the God of my mercy.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Sam 19:11-24; Ps 18:48; Ps 57:1; Isa 33:16; Luke 1:74-75
- v2** — Ps 139:19
- v3** — Ps 56:6; Ps 69:4; 1 Sam 24:11; Prov 12:6; John 15:25
- v6** — Ps 59:14
- v7** — Ps 57:4; Ps 10:11; Prov 15:2
- v8** — Ps 37:13; Prov 1:26; Ps 2:4
- v9** — Ps 9:9; Isa 26:3-4; Ps 27:14; Ps 62:2
- v10** — 1 Pet 5:10; Ps 54:7; Ps 59:17; Ps 21:3; Eph 2:4-5
- v12** — Prov 12:13; Prov 18:7; Hos 4:2; Ps 10:7
- v13** — Ps 83:18; Ps 7:9; Ezek 39:7
- v16** — Ps 21:13; Eph 3:20; Rom 15:9; Ps 30:5; Ps 143:8
- v17** — Ps 59:9-10; Ps 46:1; Ps 18:1

Psalm 60

To the chief Musician upon Shushaneduth. Michtam of David, to teach; when he strove with Aramnaharaim and with Aramzobah, when Joab returned, and smote of Edom in the valley of salt twelve thousand.

The psalmist laments that God has cast off and scattered His people after a military defeat. Yet God has spoken in His holiness, claiming Shechem, Succoth, Gilead, Ephraim, and Judah as His own. Through God the people will do valiantly, for it is He who shall tread down their enemies.

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| 1 <i>O God, thou hast cast us off, thou hast scattered us, thou hast been displeased; O turn thyself to us again.</i> | You have rejected us, God, and burst upon us; You have been angry — now restore us! |
| 2 <i>Thou hast made the earth to tremble; thou hast broken it: heal the breaches thereof; for it shaketh.</i> | You have shaken the land and torn it open; mend its fractures, for it is quaking. |
| 3 <i>Thou hast shewed thy people hard things: thou hast made us to drink the wine of astonishment.</i> | You have shown your people desperate times; you have given us wine that makes us stagger. |
| 4 <i>Thou hast given a banner to them that fear thee, that it may be displayed because of the truth. Selah.</i> | But for those who fear you, you have raised a banner to be unfurled against the bow. |
| 5 <i>That thy beloved may be delivered; save with thy right hand, and hear me.</i> | Save us and help us with your right hand, that those you love may be delivered. |
| 6 <i>God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.</i> | God has spoken in His holiness: "I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and measure out the valley of Succoth. |
| 7 <i>Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;</i> | Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine; Ephraim is my helmet, Judah is my scepter. |
| 8 <i>Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe: Philistia, triumph thou because of me.</i> | Moab is my washbasin, on Edom I toss my sandal; over Philistia I shout in triumph." |
| 9 <i>Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?</i> | Who will bring me to the fortified city? Who will lead me to Edom? |

10	<i>Wilt not thou, O God, which hadst cast us off? and thou, O God, which didst not go out with our armies?</i>	Is it not You, God, You who have now rejected us and no longer go out with our armies?
11	<i>Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.</i>	Give us help from trouble, for vain is the help of man.
12	<i>Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.</i>	With God we will gain the victory. He will trample down our enemies.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Sam 8:12-13; 2 Sam 8:3; Ps 44:9
- v2 — 2 Chr 7:14; Isa 30:26; Hos 6:1
- v3 — Isa 51:17; Ps 71:20; Isa 51:22
- v4 — Ps 20:5; Ex 17:15; Isa 11:12; Isa 5:26
- v5 — Isa 41:10; Ex 15:6; Ps 17:7; Ps 108:6-13
- v6 — Gen 12:6; Ps 89:35; Josh 13:27
- v7 — Gen 49:10; Deut 33:17
- v8 — 2 Sam 8:1-2; 2 Sam 8:14
- v10 — Josh 7:12; Ps 108:11
- v11 — Ps 146:3; Ps 108:12
- v12 — Ps 44:5; Josh 1:9; Isa 63:3; Rev 19:15; 1 Chr 19:13

Psalm 61

To the chief Musician upon Neginah. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist cries to God from the end of the earth, overwhelmed and longing for the rock that is higher than he. He asks to dwell in God's tabernacle forever and to take refuge in the shelter of His wings. He prays for the king's life to be prolonged through many generations.

1	<i>Hear my cry, O God; attend unto my prayer.</i>	Hear my cry, O God; listen to my prayer.
2	<i>From the end of the earth will I cry unto thee, when my heart is overwhelmed: lead me to the rock that is higher than I.</i>	From the ends of the earth I call to you, I call as my heart grows faint; lead me to the rock that is higher than I.

3	<i>For thou hast been a shelter for me, and a strong tower from the enemy.</i>	For you have been my refuge, a strong tower against the foe.
4	<i>I will abide in thy tabernacle for ever: I will trust in the covert of thy wings. Selah.</i>	I long to dwell in your tent forever and take refuge in the shelter of your wings.
5	<i>For thou, O God, hast heard my vows: thou hast given me the heritage of those that fear thy name.</i>	For You, God, have heard my vows; You have given me the heritage of those who fear Your name.
6	<i>Thou wilt prolong the king's life: and his years as many generations.</i>	Increase the days of the king's life, his years for many generations.
7	<i>He shall abide before God for ever: O prepare mercy and truth, which may preserve him.</i>	He shall abide before God forever; prepare mercy and truth, which may preserve Him.
8	<i>So will I sing praise unto thy name for ever, that I may daily perform my vows.</i>	Then I will ever sing in praise of your name and fulfill my vows day after day.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Phil 4:6; Ps 4:1; Ps 86:6; Ps 130:2
- v2 — Ps 18:2; Ps 139:9-10; Isa 32:2; Ps 62:6; Deut 4:29
- v3 — Prov 18:10; Ps 62:7; Ps 116:2; Ps 140:7; Ps 18:2
- v4 — Ps 23:6; Ps 27:4; Ps 91:4; Ps 17:8; Ruth 2:12
- v5 — Ps 56:12; Mal 3:16-18; Ps 86:11; Ps 115:13
- v6 — Ps 21:4; Ps 89:36-37; Ps 21:6
- v7 — Ps 40:11; Gen 24:27; Luke 1:33; Isa 9:6-7; Ps 57:3
- v8 — Ps 65:1

Psalm 62

To the chief Musician, to Jeduthun. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist declares that his soul waits only on God, who alone is his rock, salvation, and defense. He rebukes those who plot against him with lying mouths, and counsels all to trust in God at all times, for power and mercy belong to the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>Truly my soul waiteth upon God: from
him cometh my salvation.</i> | Truly my soul finds rest in God; my
salvation comes from Him. |
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| <p>2 <i>He only is my rock and my salvation; he is my defence; I shall not be greatly moved.</i></p> | <p>Truly He is my rock and my salvation; He is my fortress, I will never be shaken.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>How long will ye imagine mischief against a man? ye shall be slain all of you: as a bowing wall shall ye be, and as a tottering fence.</i></p> | <p>How long will You assault me? Would all of You throw me down — this leaning wall, this tottering fence?</p> |
| <p>4 <i>They only consult to cast him down from his excellency: they delight in lies: they bless with their mouth, but they curse inwardly. Selah.</i></p> | <p>Surely they intend to topple me from my lofty place; they take delight in lies. With their mouths they bless, but in their hearts they curse.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>My soul, wait thou only upon God; for my expectation is from him.</i></p> | <p>Yes, my soul, find rest in God; my hope comes from Him.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>He only is my rock and my salvation: he is my defence; I shall not be moved.</i></p> | <p>Truly He is my rock and my salvation; He is my fortress, I will not be shaken.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>In God is my salvation and my glory: the rock of my strength, and my refuge, is in God.</i></p> | <p>My salvation and my honor depend on God; He is my mighty rock, my refuge.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Trust in him at all times; ye people, pour out your heart before him: God is a refuge for us. Selah.</i></p> | <p>Trust in Him at all times, You people; pour out Your hearts to Him, for God is our refuge.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Surely men of low degree are vanity, and men of high degree are a lie: to be laid in the balance, they are altogether lighter than vanity.</i></p> | <p>Surely the lowborn are but a breath, the highborn are but a lie. If weighed on a balance, they are nothing; together they are only a breath.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Trust not in oppression, and become not vain in robbery: if riches increase, set not your heart upon them.</i></p> | <p>Do not trust in extortion or put vain hope in stolen goods; though Your riches increase, do not set Your heart on them.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>God hath spoken once; twice have I heard this; that power belongeth unto God.</i></p> | <p>One thing God has spoken, two things I have heard: "Power belongs to You, God,</p> |

12	<i>Also unto thee, O Lord, belongeth mercy: for thou renderest to every man according to his work.</i>	Also to You, O Lord, belongs mercy; for You reward every man according to his work.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lam 3:25; Ps 62:2; Ps 37:7; Ps 33:20; Isa 40:31
- v2 — Ps 18:2; 2 Cor 4:8-9; Ps 62:6; Isa 26:4; Isa 32:2
- v3 — Jer 4:14; Ps 140:2; Ps 82:2; Prov 1:22; Isa 30:13-14
- v4 — Ps 55:21; Ps 28:3; Ps 5:9; Rom 7:22; Rom 1:32
- v5 — Mic 7:7; Ps 27:13-14; Lam 3:24-26; Ps 42:11; Ps 71:5
- v6 — Ps 62:2; Ps 112:6; Ps 16:8; Prov 10:30; Ps 18:31-32
- v7 — Ps 3:3; Isa 26:4; Ps 94:22; Ps 18:2; Ps 95:1
- v8 — Phil 4:6; Lam 2:19; Isa 26:4; Ps 142:2; 1 Sam 1:15
- v9 — Ps 39:5; Isa 40:17; Isa 40:15; Ps 118:9; Ps 39:11
- v10 — 1 Tim 6:17; Ps 52:7; Jer 17:11; Job 31:24-25; Deut 6:10-12
- v11 — Rev 19:1; Job 33:14; Isa 26:4; Job 40:5; Ps 68:34-35
- v12 — Matt 16:27; Job 34:11; Ps 103:8; Rom 2:6; Ex 34:6-7

Psalm 63

A Psalm of David, when he was in the wilderness of Judah.

The psalmist thirsts for God in a dry and parched land and declares that God's lovingkindness is better than life. He meditates on God through the night watches, rejoices in the shadow of His wings, and trusts that those who seek his life will go into the lower parts of the earth.

1	<i>O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee: my soul thirsteth for thee, my flesh longeth for thee in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is;</i>	You, God, are my God, earnestly I seek You; I thirst for You, my whole being longs for You, in a dry and parched land where there is no water.
2	<i>To see thy power and thy glory, so as I have seen thee in the sanctuary.</i>	I have seen you in the sanctuary and beheld your power and your glory.
3	<i>Because thy lovingkindness is better than life, my lips shall praise thee.</i>	Because your lovingkindness is better than life, my lips shall praise you.
4	<i>Thus will I bless thee while I live: I will lift up my hands in thy name.</i>	I will praise you as long as I live, and in your name I will lift up my hands.

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| 5 | <i>My soul shall be satisfied as with marrow and fatness; and my mouth shall praise thee with joyful lips:</i> | I will be fully satisfied as with the richest of foods; with singing lips my mouth will praise you. |
| 6 | <i>When I remember thee upon my bed, and meditate on thee in the night watches.</i> | On my bed I remember you; I think of you through the watches of the night. |
| 7 | <i>Because thou hast been my help, therefore in the shadow of thy wings will I rejoice.</i> | Because you are my help, I sing in the shadow of your wings. |
| 8 | <i>My soul followeth hard after thee: thy right hand upholdeth me.</i> | I cling to you; your right hand upholds me. |
| 9 | <i>But those that seek my soul, to destroy it, shall go into the lower parts of the earth.</i> | Those who want to kill me will be destroyed; they will go down to the depths of the earth. |
| 10 | <i>They shall fall by the sword: they shall be a portion for foxes.</i> | They will be given over to the sword and become food for jackals. |
| 11 | <i>But the king shall rejoice in God; every one that sweareth by him shall glory: but the mouth of them that speak lies shall be stopped.</i> | But the king will rejoice in God; all who swear by God will glory in Him, while the mouths of liars will be silenced. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 143:6; Ps 84:2; Ps 42:1-2; Matt 6:33; Ps 91:2
v2 — Ps 27:4; Ps 105:4; Ps 84:2-11; Ps 96:6
v3 — Phil 1:23; Ps 69:16; Ps 51:15; Ps 30:5; Heb 13:15
v4 — Ps 104:33; Ps 134:2; Ps 28:2; 1 Kgs 8:22-66; Ps 145:1-3
v5 — Ps 36:7-9; Isa 25:6; Ps 43:4; Ps 17:15; Ezra 3:11-13
v6 — Ps 42:8; Ps 119:147-148; Ps 149:5; Ps 119:55; Lam 2:19
v7 — 2 Cor 1:10; Ps 61:4; Ps 27:9; Ps 54:3-4; Ps 57:1
v8 — Isa 41:10; Ps 18:35; Ps 73:23; Song 2:6; Ps 37:24
v9 — Ps 55:15; Ps 9:17; Ps 40:14; 1 Sam 25:29
v11 — Deut 6:13; Ps 21:1; Isa 65:16; Isa 45:23; Rom 3:19

Psalm 64

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist asks God to hide him from the secret counsel of the wicked, who sharpen their tongues like swords. But God will shoot at them with His own arrow suddenly, and their own tongues will bring them to ruin. All men shall fear and declare the work of God.

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| 1 | <i>Hear my voice, O God, in my prayer: preserve my life from fear of the enemy.</i> | Hear me, my God, as I voice my complaint; protect my life from the threat of the enemy. |
| 2 | <i>Hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked; from the insurrection of the workers of iniquity:</i> | Hide me from the conspiracy of the wicked, from the plots of evildoers. |
| 3 | <i>Who whet their tongue like a sword, and bend their bows to shoot their arrows, even bitter words:</i> | They sharpen their tongues like swords and aim cruel words like deadly arrows. |
| 4 | <i>That they may shoot in secret at the perfect: suddenly do they shoot at him, and fear not.</i> | They shoot from ambush at the innocent; they shoot suddenly, without fear. |
| 5 | <i>They encourage themselves in an evil matter: they commune of laying snares privily; they say, Who shall see them?</i> | They encourage each other in evil plans, they talk about hiding their snares; they say, "Who will see it?" |
| 6 | <i>They search out iniquities; they accomplish a diligent search: both the inward thought of every one of them, and the heart, is deep.</i> | They search out iniquities; they accomplish a diligent search; both the inward thought of every one of them, and the heart, is deep. |
| 7 | <i>But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded.</i> | But God will shoot them with his arrows; they will suddenly be struck down. |
| 8 | <i>So they shall make their own tongue to fall upon themselves: all that see them shall flee away.</i> | He will turn their own tongues against them and bring them to ruin; all who see them will shake their heads in scorn. |
| 9 | <i>And all men shall fear, and shall declare the work of God; for they shall wisely consider of his doing.</i> | All people will fear; they will proclaim the works of God and ponder what He has done. |

10	<i>The righteous shall be glad in the LORD, and shall trust in him; and all the upright in heart shall glory.</i>	The righteous will rejoice in the LORD and take refuge in Him; all the upright in heart will glory in Him!
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 143:1-3; Ps 34:4
- v2 — Ps 31:20; Ps 59:2; Ps 143:9; Ps 27:5; Ps 109:2-3
- v3 — Ps 58:7; Jer 9:3; Ps 57:4; Jas 3:6-8
- v5 — Ps 140:5; Ps 10:11
- v6 — Matt 26:59; Jer 17:9-10; Isa 29:15; Ps 5:9; 1 Cor 4:5
- v7 — Ps 7:12-13; Prov 6:15; Ps 18:14; 1 Thess 5:2-3
- v8 — Prov 18:7; Prov 12:13; Ps 140:9
- v9 — Jer 51:10
- v10 — Ps 32:11-33:1; 1 Cor 1:30-31; Ps 40:3; Ps 112:2; Ps 25:20

Psalm 65

To the chief Musician. A Psalm and Song of David.

The psalmist praises God in Zion for hearing prayer and forgiving transgressions. He celebrates God's awesome works in nature -- setting fast the mountains, stilling the seas, and crowning the year with goodness so that the pastures and valleys shout for joy and sing.

1	<i>Praise waiteth for thee, O God, in Sion: and unto thee shall the vow be performed.</i>	Praise awaits You, our God, in Zion; to You our vows will be fulfilled.
2	<i>O thou that hearest prayer, unto thee shall all flesh come.</i>	You who answer prayer, to you all people will come.
3	<i>Iniquities prevail against me: as for our transgressions, thou shalt purge them away.</i>	When we were overwhelmed by sins, you forgave our transgressions.
4	<i>Blessed is the man whom thou choosest, and causest to approach unto thee, that he may dwell in thy courts: we shall be satisfied with the goodness of thy house, even of thy holy temple.</i>	Blessed are those you choose and bring near to live in your courts! We are filled with the good things of your house, of your holy temple.

- 5 *By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us, O God of our salvation; who art the confidence of all the ends of the earth, and of them that are afar off upon the sea:* You answer us with awesome and righteous deeds, God our Savior, the hope of all the ends of the earth and of the farthest seas,
- 6 *Which by his strength setteth fast the mountains; being girded with power:* who formed the mountains by your power, having armed yourself with strength,
- 7 *Which stilleth the noise of the seas, the noise of their waves, and the tumult of the people.* who stilled the roaring of the seas, the roaring of their waves, and the turmoil of the nations.
- 8 *They also that dwell in the uttermost parts are afraid at thy tokens: thou makest the outgoings of the morning and evening to rejoice.* The whole earth is filled with awe at your wonders; where morning dawns, where evening fades, you call forth songs of joy.
- 9 *Thou visitest the earth, and waterest it: thou greatly enrichest it with the river of God, which is full of water: thou preparest them corn, when thou hast so provided for it.* You care for the land and water it; you enrich it abundantly. The streams of God are filled with water to provide the people with grain, for so you have ordained it.
- 10 *Thou waterest the ridges thereof abundantly: thou settlest the furrows thereof: thou makest it soft with showers: thou blessest the springing thereof.* You drench its furrows and level its ridges; you soften it with showers and bless its crops.
- 11 *Thou crownest the year with thy goodness; and thy paths drop fatness.* You crown the year with your bounty, and your carts overflow with abundance.
- 12 *They drop upon the pastures of the wilderness: and the little hills rejoice on every side.* The grasslands of the wilderness overflow; the hills are clothed with gladness.

- 13 *The pastures are clothed with flocks;
the valleys also are covered over with
corn; they shout for joy, they also
sing.*
- The meadows are covered with flocks
and the valleys are mantled with grain;
they shout for joy and sing.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 62:1; Ps 76:11; Ps 116:17-18; Ps 21:13; Ps 56:12
- v2 — Jer 29:12-13; Isa 65:24; Isa 66:23; 1 John 5:14-15; Ps 86:9
- v3 — Ps 38:4; Isa 6:7; Ps 79:9; 1 John 1:7-9; Heb 9:14
- v4 — Eph 1:4; Ps 84:4; Ps 23:6; Ps 106:4-5; Ps 33:12
- v5 — Deut 10:21; Isa 45:22; Ps 66:3; Rev 15:3-4; Ps 45:4
- v6 — Ps 93:1; Hab 3:6
- v7 — Ps 89:9; Ps 93:3-4; Isa 17:12-13
- v8 — Ps 148:3; Ps 104:20-23; Ps 136:8; Ps 74:16; Hab 3:3-19
- v9 — Ps 46:4; Rev 22:1; Ps 104:13-15; Jer 5:24; Ps 68:9-10
- v11 — Joel 2:21-26; Ps 103:4; Ps 5:12; Ps 36:8; Hag 2:19
- v12 — Job 38:26-27
- v13 — Isa 55:12; Isa 35:1-2; Acts 14:17; Isa 30:23

Psalm 66

To the chief Musician. A Song or Psalm.

The psalmist calls all the earth to make a joyful noise to God and to come see His awesome works. He recounts how God turned the sea to dry land, brought His people through fire and water into a wealthy place, and hears prayer because He has not turned away His mercy.

- 1 *Make a joyful noise unto God, all ye
lands:*
- Shout for joy to God, all the earth!
- 2 *Sing forth the honour of his name:
make his praise glorious.*
- Sing the glory of his name; make his
praise glorious.
- 3 *Say unto God, How terrible are thy
works! through the greatness of thy
power shall thine enemies submit
themselves unto thee.*
- Say to God, "How awesome are Your
deeds! So great is Your power that
Your enemies cringe before You.
- 4 *All the earth shall worship thee, and
shall sing unto thee; they shall sing to
thy name. Selah.*
- All the earth bows down to you; they
sing praise to you, they sing the praises
of your name."

- 5 *Come and see the works of God: he is terrible in his doing toward the children of men.* Come and see what God has done, His awesome deeds for mankind!
- 6 *He turned the sea into dry land: they went through the flood on foot: there did we rejoice in him.* He turned the sea into dry land, they passed through the waters on foot — come, let us rejoice in him.
- 7 *He ruleth by his power for ever; his eyes behold the nations: let not the rebellious exalt themselves. Selah.* He rules forever by his power, his eyes watch the nations — let not the rebellious rise up against him.
- 8 *O bless our God, ye people, and make the voice of his praise to be heard:* Praise our God, all peoples, let the sound of His praise be heard;
- 9 *Which holdeth our soul in life, and suffereth not our feet to be moved.* he has preserved our lives and kept our feet from slipping.
- 10 *For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.* For You, God, tested us; You refined us like silver.
- 11 *Thou broughtest us into the net; thou laidst affliction upon our loins.* You brought us into prison and laid burdens on our backs.
- 12 *Thou hast caused men to ride over our heads; we went through fire and through water: but thou broughtest us out into a wealthy place.* You let people ride over our heads; we went through fire and water, but you brought us to a place of abundance.
- 13 *I will go into thy house with burnt offerings: I will pay thee my vows,* I will come to your temple with burnt offerings and fulfill my vows to you —
- 14 *Which my lips have uttered, and my mouth hath spoken, when I was in trouble.* vows my lips promised and my mouth spoke when I was in trouble.
- 15 *I will offer unto thee burnt sacrifices of fatlings, with the incense of rams; I will offer bullocks with goats. Selah.* I will sacrifice fat animals to you and an offering of rams; I will offer bulls and goats.
- 16 *Come and hear, all ye that fear God, and I will declare what he hath done for my soul.* Come and hear, all you who fear God; let me tell you what He has done for me.

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| 17 <i>I cried unto him with my mouth, and he was extolled with my tongue.</i> | I cried out to him with my mouth; his praise was on my tongue. |
| 18 <i>If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me:</i> | If I had cherished sin in my heart, the Lord would not have listened; |
| 19 <i>But verily God hath heard me; he hath attended to the voice of my prayer.</i> | but God has surely listened and has heard my prayer. |
| 20 <i>Blessed be God, which hath not turned away my prayer, nor his mercy from me.</i> | Blessed be God, Who has not turned away my prayer, nor His mercy from me. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 16:23-24; Ps 100:1; Ps 98:4; Ps 150:6; Ps 81:1
v2 — Ps 105:2-3; Isa 49:13; Rev 5:13; Isa 42:12; Neh 9:5
v3 — Ps 18:44; Ps 65:5; Ps 81:15; Ps 47:2
v4 — Ps 22:27; Ps 117:1; Ps 96:1-2; Rev 15:4; Mal 1:11
v9 — Ps 121:3; Ps 112:6; Ps 94:18; Ps 37:23-24; 1 Sam 2:9
v10 — Isa 48:10; Ps 17:3; 1 Pet 1:6-7; Prov 17:3; Job 23:10
v12 — Isa 43:1-2; Isa 51:23; Jas 5:11; Ps 40:2-3; Rev 7:14-17
v13 — Ps 100:4; Eccl 5:4; Ps 56:12; Ps 116:17-19; Ps 116:14
v16 — Ps 71:15; Ps 34:11; Mal 3:16; Ps 71:18; Ps 66:5
v18 — John 9:31; Prov 28:9; Prov 15:29; Prov 15:8; Isa 1:15
v19 — Ps 116:1-2; Heb 5:7; Lam 3:55-56; Ps 6:9
v20 — Ps 86:12-13; Ps 68:35; Ps 51:11; 2 Sam 7:14-15

Psalm 67

To the chief Musician on Neginoth. A Psalm or Song.

The psalmist asks God to be merciful and cause His face to shine on His people, so that His way may be known on earth and His salvation among all nations. He calls all the peoples to praise God and asks the earth to yield her increase.

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| 1 <i>God be merciful unto us, and bless us; and cause his face to shine upon us; Selah.</i> | God be merciful to us, and bless us, and cause His countenance to shine on us. Selah. |
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2	<i>That thy way may be known upon earth, thy saving health among all nations.</i>	so that your ways may be known on earth, your salvation among all nations.
3	<i>Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.</i>	May the peoples praise you, God; may all the peoples praise you.
4	<i>O let the nations be glad and sing for joy: for thou shalt judge the people righteously, and govern the nations upon earth. Selah.</i>	May the nations be glad and sing for joy, for you rule the peoples with equity and guide the nations of the earth.
5	<i>Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.</i>	May the peoples praise you, God; may all the peoples praise you.
6	<i>Then shall the earth yield her increase; and God, even our own God, shall bless us.</i>	The land yields its harvest; God, our God, blesses us.
7	<i>God shall bless us; and all the ends of the earth shall fear him.</i>	May God bless us still, so that all the ends of the earth will fear Him.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 4:6; 2 Cor 4:6; Ps 4:1; Num 6:24-27; Ps 80:1-3
- v2 — Titus 2:11; Ps 98:2-3; Acts 18:25; Luke 2:30-31; Luke 3:6
- v3 — Ps 67:5; Ps 74:21; Ps 45:17; Ps 119:175
- v4 — Ps 98:9; Rom 15:10-11; Ps 9:8; Isa 42:10-12; Ps 82:6
- v5 — Ps 67:3; Matt 6:9-10
- v6 — Lev 26:4; Ex 3:15; Ps 85:9-12; Hos 2:21-22; Ezek 34:26-27
- v7 — Ps 22:27; Isa 45:22; Acts 13:26

Psalm 68

To the chief Musician. A Psalm or Song of David.

The psalmist calls on God to arise and scatter His enemies like smoke. He celebrates the LORD as a father of the fatherless, a God who rides on the heavens and led His people through the wilderness. He recounts God's triumphant ascent to the high place, receiving gifts for men, and praises His awesome power from the sanctuary.

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| 1 | <i>Let God arise, let his enemies be scattered: let them also that hate him flee before him.</i> | May God arise, may His enemies be scattered; may His foes flee before Him. |
| 2 | <i>As smoke is driven away, so drive them away: as wax melteth before the fire, so let the wicked perish at the presence of God.</i> | May you blow them away like smoke — as wax melts before the fire, may the wicked perish before God. |
| 3 | <i>But let the righteous be glad; let them rejoice before God: yea, let them exceedingly rejoice.</i> | But may the righteous be glad and rejoice before God; may they be happy and joyful. |
| 4 | <i>Sing unto God, sing praises to his name: extol him that rideth upon the heavens by his name JAH, and rejoice before him.</i> | Sing to God, sing in praise of His name, extol Him who rides on the clouds; rejoice before Him — His name is the LORD. |
| 5 | <i>A father of the fatherless, and a judge of the widows, is God in his holy habitation.</i> | A father to the fatherless, a defender of widows, is God in His holy dwelling. |
| 6 | <i>God setteth the solitary in families: he bringeth out those which are bound with chains: but the rebellious dwell in a dry land.</i> | God sets the lonely in families, He leads out the prisoners with singing; but the rebellious live in a sun-scorched land. |
| 7 | <i>O God, when thou wentest forth before thy people, when thou didst march through the wilderness; Selah:</i> | When You, God, went out before Your people, when You marched through the wilderness, |
| 8 | <i>The earth shook, the heavens also dropped at the presence of God: even Sinai itself was moved at the presence of God, the God of Israel.</i> | the earth shook, the heavens poured down rain, before God, the One of Sinai, before God, the God of Israel. |
| 9 | <i>Thou, O God, didst send a plentiful rain, whereby thou didst confirm thine inheritance, when it was weary.</i> | You gave abundant showers, O God; You refreshed Your weary inheritance. |
| 10 | <i>Thy congregation hath dwelt therein: thou, O God, hast prepared of thy goodness for the poor.</i> | Your people settled in it, and from Your bounty, God, You provided for the poor. |

- 11 *The Lord gave the word: great was the company of those that published it.* The Lord announces the word, and the women who proclaim it are a mighty throng:
- 12 *Kings of armies did flee apace: and she that tarried at home divided the spoil.* "Kings and their armies flee in haste; the women at home divide the plunder."
- 13 *Though ye have lien among the pots, yet shall ye be as the wings of a dove covered with silver, and her feathers with yellow gold.* Even while You sleep among the sheep pens, the wings of my dove are sheathed with silver, its feathers with shining gold.
- 14 *When the Almighty scattered kings in it, it was white as snow in Salmon.* When the Almighty scattered the kings in the land, it was like snow fallen on Zalmon.
- 15 *The hill of God is as the hill of Bashan; an high hill as the hill of Bashan.* Mount Bashan, majestic mountain, Mount Bashan, rugged mountain,
- 16 *Why leap ye, ye high hills? this is the hill which God desireth to dwell in; yea, the LORD will dwell in it for ever.* why gaze in envy, You rugged mountain, at the mountain where God chooses to reign, where the LORD Himself will dwell forever?
- 17 *The chariots of God are twenty thousand, even thousands of angels: the Lord is among them, as in Sinai, in the holy place.* The chariots of God are tens of thousands and thousands of thousands; the Lord has come from Sinai into His sanctuary.
- 18 *Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also, that the LORD God might dwell among them.* When You ascended on high, You took many captives; You received gifts from people, even from the rebellious — that You, LORD God, might dwell there.
- 19 *Blessed be the Lord, who daily loadeth us with benefits, even the God of our salvation. Selah.* Praise be to the Lord, to God our Savior, who daily bears our burdens.

- 20 *He that is our God is the God of salvation; and unto GOD the Lord belong the issues from death.* He who is our God is the God of salvation; and to GOD the Lord belong the issues from death.
- 21 *But God shall wound the head of his enemies, and the hairy scalp of such an one as goeth on still in his trespasses.* Surely God will crush the heads of His enemies, the hairy crowns of those who go on in their sins.
- 22 *The Lord said, I will bring again from Bashan, I will bring my people again from the depths of the sea:* The Lord says, "I will bring them from Bashan; I will bring them from the depths of the sea,
- 23 *That thy foot may be dipped in the blood of thine enemies, and the tongue of thy dogs in the same.* that Your feet may wade in the blood of Your foes, while the tongues of Your dogs have their share."
- 24 *They have seen thy goings, O God; even the goings of my God, my King, in the sanctuary.* Your procession, God, has come into view, the procession of my God and King into the sanctuary.
- 25 *The singers went before, the players on instruments followed after; among them were the damsels playing with timbrels.* In front are the singers, after them the musicians; with them are the young women playing the timbrels.
- 26 *Bless ye God in the congregations, even the Lord, from the fountain of Israel.* Praise God in the great congregation; praise the LORD in the assembly of Israel.
- 27 *There is little Benjamin with their ruler, the princes of Judah and their council, the princes of Zebulun, and the princes of Naphtali.* There is the little tribe of Benjamin, leading them, there the great throng of Judah's princes, and there the princes of Zebulun and of Naphtali.
- 28 *Thy God hath commanded thy strength: strengthen, O God, that which thou hast wrought for us.* Summon Your power, God; show us Your strength, our God, as You have done before.
- 29 *Because of thy temple at Jerusalem shall kings bring presents unto thee.* Because of Your temple at Jerusalem kings will bring You gifts.

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| <p>30 <i>Rebuke the company of spearmen, the multitude of the bulls, with the calves of the people, till every one submit himself with pieces of silver: scatter thou the people that delight in war.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Princes shall come out of Egypt; Ethiopia shall soon stretch out her hands unto God.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Sing unto God, ye kingdoms of the earth; O sing praises unto the Lord; Selah:</i></p> <p>33 <i>To him that rideth upon the heavens of heavens, which were of old; lo, he doth send out his voice, and that a mighty voice.</i></p> <p>34 <i>Ascribe ye strength unto God: his excellency is over Israel, and his strength is in the clouds.</i></p> <p>35 <i>O God, thou art terrible out of thy holy places: the God of Israel is he that giveth strength and power unto his people. Blessed be God.</i></p> | <p>Rebuke the beast among the reeds, the herd of bulls among the calves of the nations. Humbled, may the beast bring bars of silver. Scatter the nations who delight in war.</p> <p>Envoys will come from Egypt; Cush will submit herself to God.</p> <p>Sing to God, You kingdoms of the earth, sing praise to the Lord,</p> <p>to him who rides across the highest heavens, the ancient heavens, who thunders with mighty voice.</p> <p>Proclaim the power of God, whose majesty is over Israel, whose power is in the heavens.</p> <p>You, God, are awesome in Your sanctuary; the God of Israel gives power and strength to His people. Praise be to God!</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Num 10:35; Isa 51:9-10; Isa 42:13-14; Ps 89:10; Ps 44:26
- v3** — Ps 64:10; 1 Thess 5:16; Rev 18:20; Ps 100:1-2; 1 Pet 1:8
- v5** — Jer 49:11; Ps 10:14; Ps 82:3-4; Deut 10:18; Jer 5:28
- v6** — Ps 69:33; Ps 113:9; Ps 107:10; Isa 61:1; Ps 107:14
- v8** — Ex 19:18; Ex 19:16; Judg 5:4-5; Deut 5:23-25; Heb 12:26
- v11** — Ex 15:20; Ps 40:3; Ps 68:25; Ex 17:9-16
- v17** — Deut 33:2; Dan 7:10; Rev 5:11; Rev 9:16; Matt 26:53
- v18** — Eph 4:8-10; Rev 21:3; 2 Cor 6:16; 1 Pet 3:22; Ps 110:1
- v19** — Isa 46:4; Lam 3:23; Ps 55:22; Eph 1:3; Ps 103:1-22
- v20** — Deut 32:39; Rev 1:18; John 5:21; Isa 12:2; 1 Sam 2:6
- v28** — Phil 1:6; Ps 138:8; Ps 71:3; Ps 42:8; Isa 40:31

v35 — Ps 29:11; Col 1:11; Phil 4:13; Isa 40:29; Zech 10:12

Psalm 69

To the chief Musician upon Shoshannim. A Psalm of David.

The psalmist sinks in deep mire as waters rise to his neck, crying for God to save him. Zeal for God's house has consumed him, and the reproaches of those who reproach God have fallen on him. He prophetically describes being given gall and vinegar to drink and calls on God to vindicate him -- a psalm the apostles applied to Christ's suffering.

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| 1 | <i>Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto my soul.</i> | Save me, O God, for the waters have come up to my neck. |
| 2 | <i>I sink in deep mire, where there is no standing: I am come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me.</i> | I sink in the miry depths, where there is no foothold. I have come into the deep waters; the floods engulf me. |
| 3 | <i>I am weary of my crying: my throat is dried: mine eyes fail while I wait for my God.</i> | I am worn out calling for help; my throat is parched. My eyes fail, looking for my God. |
| 4 | <i>They that hate me without a cause are more than the hairs of mine head: they that would destroy me, being mine enemies wrongfully, are mighty: then I restored that which I took not away.</i> | Those who hate me without reason outnumber the hairs of my head; many are my enemies without cause, those who seek to destroy me. I am forced to restore what I did not steal. |
| 5 | <i>O God, thou knowest my foolishness; and my sins are not hid from thee.</i> | You, God, know my folly; my guilt is not hidden from You. |
| 6 | <i>Let not them that wait on thee, O Lord GOD of hosts, be ashamed for my sake: let not those that seek thee be confounded for my sake, O God of Israel.</i> | Let not those who wait on You, O Lord GOD of hosts, be ashamed for my sake; let not those who seek You be confounded for my sake, O God of Israel. |
| 7 | <i>Because for thy sake I have borne reproach; shame hath covered my face.</i> | For I endure scorn for Your sake, and shame covers my face. |

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| 8 <i>I am become a stranger unto my brethren, and an alien unto my mother's children.</i> | I am a foreigner to my own family, a stranger to my own mother's children; |
| 9 <i>For the zeal of thine house hath eaten me up; and the reproaches of them that reproached thee are fallen upon me.</i> | for zeal for Your house consumes me, and the insults of those who insult You fall on me. |
| 10 <i>When I wept, and chastened my soul with fasting, that was to my reproach.</i> | When I weep and fast, I must endure scorn; |
| 11 <i>I made sackcloth also my garment; and I became a proverb to them.</i> | when I put on sackcloth, people make sport of me. |
| 12 <i>They that sit in the gate speak against me; and I was the song of the drunkards.</i> | Those who sit at the gate mock me. I am the song of the drunkards. |
| 13 <i>But as for me, my prayer is unto thee, O LORD, in an acceptable time: O God, in the multitude of thy mercy hear me, in the truth of thy salvation.</i> | But as for me, my prayer is to You, O LORD, in an acceptable time; O God, in the multitude of Your mercy hear me, in the truth of Your salvation. |
| 14 <i>Deliver me out of the mire, and let me not sink: let me be delivered from them that hate me, and out of the deep waters.</i> | Rescue me from the mire, do not let me sink; deliver me from those who hate me, from the deep waters. |
| 15 <i>Let not the waterflood overflow me, neither let the deep swallow me up, and let not the pit shut her mouth upon me.</i> | Do not let the floodwaters engulf me or the depths swallow me up or the pit close its mouth over me. |
| 16 <i>Hear me, O LORD; for thy lovingkindness is good: turn unto me according to the multitude of thy tender mercies.</i> | Hear me, O LORD, for Your lovingkindness is good; turn to me according to the multitude of Your tender mercies. |
| 17 <i>And hide not thy face from thy servant; for I am in trouble: hear me speedily.</i> | Do not hide Your face from Your servant; answer me quickly, for I am in trouble. |

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| 18 | <i>Draw nigh unto my soul, and redeem it: deliver me because of mine enemies.</i> | Come near and rescue me; deliver me because of my foes. |
| 19 | <i>Thou hast known my reproach, and my shame, and my dishonour: mine adversaries are all before thee.</i> | You know how I am scorned, disgraced and shamed; all my enemies are before You. |
| 20 | <i>Reproach hath broken my heart; and I am full of heaviness: and I looked for some to take pity, but there was none; and for comforters, but I found none.</i> | Scorn has broken my heart and has left me helpless; I looked for sympathy, but there was none, for comforters. But I found none. |
| 21 | <i>They gave me also gall for my meat; and in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink.</i> | They put gall in my food and gave me vinegar for my thirst. |
| 22 | <i>Let their table become a snare before them: and that which should have been for their welfare, let it become a trap.</i> | May the table set before them become a snare; may it become retribution and a trap. |
| 23 | <i>Let their eyes be darkened, that they see not; and make their loins continually to shake.</i> | May their eyes be darkened so they cannot see. Their backs be bent forever. |
| 24 | <i>Pour out thine indignation upon them, and let thy wrathful anger take hold of them.</i> | Pour out Your wrath on them; let Your fierce anger overtake them. |
| 25 | <i>Let their habitation be desolate; and let none dwell in their tents.</i> | May their place be deserted; let there be no one to dwell in their tents. |
| 26 | <i>For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten; and they talk to the grief of those whom thou hast wounded.</i> | For they persecute those You wound and talk about the pain of those You hurt. |
| 27 | <i>Add iniquity unto their iniquity: and let them not come into thy righteousness.</i> | Charge them with crime upon crime; do not let them share in Your salvation. |
| 28 | <i>Let them be blotted out of the book of the living, and not be written with the righteous.</i> | May they be blotted out of the book of life and not be listed with the righteous. |

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| 29 | <i>But I am poor and sorrowful: let thy salvation, O God, set me up on high.</i> | But as for me, afflicted and in pain — may Your salvation, God, protect me. |
| 30 | <i>I will praise the name of God with a song, and will magnify him with thanksgiving.</i> | I will praise God's name in song and glorify Him with thanksgiving. |
| 31 | <i>This also shall please the LORD better than an ox or bullock that hath horns and hoofs.</i> | This will please the LORD more than an ox, more than a bull with its horns and hooves. |
| 32 | <i>The humble shall see this, and be glad: and your heart shall live that seek God.</i> | The poor will see and be glad — you who seek God, may Your hearts live! |
| 33 | <i>For the LORD heareth the poor, and despiseth not his prisoners.</i> | The LORD hears the needy and does not despise His captive people. |
| 34 | <i>Let the heaven and earth praise him, the seas, and every thing that moveth therein.</i> | Let heaven and earth praise Him, the seas and all that move in them, |
| 35 | <i>For God will save Zion, and will build the cities of Judah: that they may dwell there, and have it in possession.</i> | for God will save Zion and rebuild the cities of Judah. Then people will settle there and possess it; |
| 36 | <i>The seed also of his servants shall inherit it: and they that love his name shall dwell therein.</i> | the children of His servants will inherit it, and those who love his name will dwell there. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 40:2; Matt 7:25; Ps 88:6-7; Ps 32:6; Jer 38:6
v4 — Ps 35:19; John 15:25; Ps 109:3-5; Ps 35:11-12; Isa 53:4-7
v9 — Rom 15:3; John 2:14-17; Ps 119:139; Mark 11:15-17; 1 Kgs 19:10
v13 — 2 Cor 6:2; Isa 49:8; Ps 55:16-17; Ps 91:15; Ps 40:10-11
v16 — Ps 109:21; Ps 25:16; Ps 63:3; Mic 7:19; Ps 26:11
v21 — Matt 27:34; Luke 23:36; Mark 15:23; Matt 27:48; Mark 15:36
v25 — Acts 1:20; Matt 23:38; Jer 7:12-14; Luke 13:35; Isa 6:11
v28 — Phil 4:3; Luke 10:20; Ex 32:32-33; Rev 13:8; Ezek 13:9
v30 — Ps 28:7; Ps 34:3; Ps 118:28-29; Ps 40:1-3; Ps 50:14
v32 — Ps 22:26; John 16:22; Isa 55:6-7; Ps 34:2; Isa 61:1-3

v33 — Ps 68:6; Acts 5:18-19; Zech 9:11-12; Rev 2:10; Luke 4:18
v34 — Isa 49:13; Ps 150:6; Ps 96:11; Isa 55:12; Ps 148:1-14

Psalm 70

The psalmist urgently pleads for God to hasten to deliver him. He asks that those who seek his life be put to shame, while those who seek God rejoice. Poor and needy, he declares God is his help and deliverer and begs the LORD not to delay.

1	<i>Make haste, O God, to deliver me; make haste to help me, O LORD.</i>	Hasten, O God, to save me; come quickly, LORD, to help me.
2	<i>Let them be ashamed and confounded that seek after my soul: let them be turned backward, and put to confusion, that desire my hurt.</i>	May those who want to take my life be put to shame and confusion; may all who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace.
3	<i>Let them be turned back for a reward of their shame that say, Aha, aha.</i>	May those who say to me, "Aha! Aha!" turn back because of their shame.
4	<i>Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee: and let such as love thy salvation say continually, Let God be magnified.</i>	But may all who seek You rejoice and be glad in You; may those who long for Your saving help always say, "The LORD is great!"
5	<i>But I am poor and needy: make haste unto me, O God: thou art my help and my deliverer; O LORD, make no tarrying.</i>	But as for me, I am poor and needy; come quickly to me, O God. You are my help and my deliverer; LORD, do not delay.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 40:13-17; Ps 143:7; Ps 71:12; Ps 69:18; Ps 38:1
v2 — Ps 35:4; Ps 35:26; Isa 41:11; Ps 71:13; Ps 109:29
v3 — Ps 40:15
v4 — Ps 40:16; Lam 3:25; Ps 35:27; Isa 61:10; Isa 65:13-14
v5 — Ps 40:17; Ps 141:1; Rev 22:20; Ps 69:29; Heb 10:37

Psalm 71

The psalmist, now old and gray-headed, takes refuge in the LORD who has been his trust from youth and his hope from his mother's womb. He asks God not to cast him off in the time of old age, and vows to praise God's righteousness and declare His wondrous works to the next

generation.

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| 1 <i>In thee, O LORD, do I put my trust:
let me never be put to confusion.</i> | In You, LORD, I have taken refuge; let me never be put to shame. |
| 2 <i>Deliver me in thy righteousness, and
cause me to escape: incline thine ear
unto me, and save me.</i> | In Your righteousness, rescue me and deliver me; turn Your ear to me and save me. |
| 3 <i>Be thou my strong habitation,
whereunto I may continually resort:
thou hast given commandment to save
me; for thou art my rock and my
fortress.</i> | Be my rock of refuge, to which I can always go; give the command to save me, for You are my rock and my fortress. |
| 4 <i>Deliver me, O my God, out of the
hand of the wicked, out of the hand of
the unrighteous and cruel man.</i> | Deliver me, my God, from the hand of the wicked, from the grasp of those who are evil and cruel. |
| 5 <i>For thou art my hope, O Lord GOD:
thou art my trust from my youth.</i> | For You are my hope, O Lord GOD; You are my trust from my youth. |
| 6 <i>By thee have I been holden up from
the womb: thou art he that took me
out of my mother's bowels: my praise
shall be continually of thee.</i> | From birth I have relied on You; You brought me forth from my mother's womb. I will ever praise You. |
| 7 <i>I am as a wonder unto many; but thou
art my strong refuge.</i> | I have become a sign to many; You are my strong refuge. |
| 8 <i>Let my mouth be filled with thy praise
and with thy honour all the day.</i> | My mouth is filled with Your praise, declaring Your splendor all day long. |
| 9 <i>Cast me not off in the time of old age;
forsake me not when my strength
faileth.</i> | Do not cast me away when I am old; do not forsake me when my strength is gone. |
| 10 <i>For mine enemies speak against me;
and they that lay wait for my soul take
counsel together,</i> | For my enemies speak against me; those who wait to kill me conspire together. |
| 11 <i>Saying, God hath forsaken him:
persecute and take him; for there is
none to deliver him.</i> | They say, "God has forsaken Him; pursue Him and seize Him, for no one will rescue him." |

- 12 *O God, be not far from me: O my God, make haste for my help.* Do not be far from me, my God; come quickly, God, to help me.
- 13 *Let them be confounded and consumed that are adversaries to my soul; let them be covered with reproach and dishonour that seek my hurt.* May my accusers perish in shame; may those who want to harm me be covered with scorn and disgrace.
- 14 *But I will hope continually, and will yet praise thee more and more.* As for me, I will always have hope; I will praise You more and more.
- 15 *My mouth shall shew forth thy righteousness and thy salvation all the day; for I know not the numbers thereof.* My mouth will tell of Your righteous deeds, of Your saving acts all day long — though I know not how to relate them all.
- 16 *I will go in the strength of the Lord GOD: I will make mention of thy righteousness, even of thine only.* I will go in the strength of the Lord GOD; I will make mention of Your righteousness, even of Yours only.
- 17 *O God, thou hast taught me from my youth: and hitherto have I declared thy wondrous works.* Since my youth, God, You have taught me, and to this day I declare Your marvelous deeds.
- 18 *Now also when I am old and greyheaded, O God, forsake me not; until I have shewed thy strength unto this generation, and thy power to every one that is to come.* Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, my God, till I declare Your power to the next generation, Your mighty acts to all who are to come.
- 19 *Thy righteousness also, O God, is very high, who hast done great things: O God, who is like unto thee!* Your righteousness, God, reaches to the heavens, You who have done great things. Who is like You, God?
- 20 *Thou, which hast shewed me great and sore troubles, shalt quicken me again, and shalt bring me up again from the depths of the earth.* Though You have made me see troubles, many and bitter, You will restore my life again; from the depths of the earth You will again bring me up.
- 21 *Thou shalt increase my greatness, and comfort me on every side.* You will increase my honor and comfort me once more.

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| <p>22 <i>I will also praise thee with the psaltery, even thy truth, O my God: unto thee will I sing with the harp, O thou Holy One of Israel.</i></p> <p>23 <i>My lips shall greatly rejoice when I sing unto thee; and my soul, which thou hast redeemed.</i></p> <p>24 <i>My tongue also shall talk of thy righteousness all the day long: for they are confounded, for they are brought unto shame, that seek my hurt.</i></p> | <p>I will praise You with the harp for Your faithfulness, my God; I will sing praise to You with the lyre, Holy One of Israel.</p> <p>My lips will shout for joy when I sing praise to You — I whom You have delivered.</p> <p>My tongue will tell of Your righteous acts all day long, for those who wanted to harm me have been put to shame and confusion.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 31:1-3; Ps 25:2-3; Ps 22:5; 1 Pet 2:6; Jer 17:18
- v3 — Ps 18:2; Prov 18:10; Ps 31:2-3; Deut 33:27; Ps 91:9
- v5 — Jer 17:7; Ps 39:7; Ps 119:81; Ps 71:17; Jer 17:17
- v6 — Jer 1:5; Ps 22:9-10; Ps 139:15-16; Gal 1:15; Isa 49:5
- v7 — Isa 8:18; Ps 62:7; Acts 4:13; 1 Cor 4:9; 2 Cor 6:8-10
- v8 — Ps 35:28; Ps 146:2; Ps 104:1; Ps 71:15; Ps 71:24
- v9 — 2 Tim 1:12; Isa 46:4; Ps 71:18; Ps 92:13-15; Ps 90:10
- v14 — 1 John 3:3; Ps 130:7; Ps 43:5; Lam 3:26; Ps 71:6
- v15 — Ps 40:5; Ps 35:28; Ps 71:8; Ps 145:2; Ps 145:5-14
- v18 — Isa 46:4; Ps 78:4; Ps 71:9; Ps 145:4-5; Ps 78:6
- v19 — Ps 35:10; Ps 36:5-6; Ps 57:10; Isa 55:9; Ps 86:8
- v20 — Ps 138:7; Ps 60:3; Hos 6:1-2; Ps 86:13; Ezek 37:12-13

Psalm 72

The psalmist prays for the king to judge the people with righteousness and the poor with justice. The king's dominion shall reach from sea to sea, all kings shall fall down before him, and his name shall endure forever. The psalm closes with a doxology: blessed be the LORD God of Israel who alone does wondrous things.

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| <p>1 <i>Give the king thy judgments, O God, and thy righteousness unto the king's son.</i></p> | <p>Endow the king with your justice, O God, the royal son with Your righteousness.</p> |
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| 2 | <i>He shall judge thy people with righteousness, and thy poor with judgment.</i> | May he judge your people in righteousness, your afflicted ones with justice. |
| 3 | <i>The mountains shall bring peace to the people, and the little hills, by righteousness.</i> | May the mountains bring prosperity to the people, the hills the fruit of righteousness. |
| 4 | <i>He shall judge the poor of the people, he shall save the children of the needy, and shall break in pieces the oppressor.</i> | May he defend the afflicted among the people and save the children of the needy; may he crush the oppressor. |
| 5 | <i>They shall fear thee as long as the sun and moon endure, throughout all generations.</i> | May he endure as long as the sun, as long as the moon, through all generations. |
| 6 | <i>He shall come down like rain upon the mown grass: as showers that water the earth.</i> | May he be like rain falling on a mown field, like showers watering the earth. |
| 7 | <i>In his days shall the righteous flourish; and abundance of peace so long as the moon endureth.</i> | In his days may the righteous flourish and prosperity abound till the moon is no more. |
| 8 | <i>He shall have dominion also from sea to sea, and from the river unto the ends of the earth.</i> | May he rule from sea to sea and from the River to the ends of the earth. |
| 9 | <i>They that dwell in the wilderness shall bow before him; and his enemies shall lick the dust.</i> | May the desert tribes bow before him and his enemies lick the dust. |
| 10 | <i>The kings of Tarshish and of the isles shall bring presents: the kings of Sheba and Seba shall offer gifts.</i> | May the kings of Tarshish and of distant shores bring tribute to him.
May the kings of Sheba and Seba present him gifts. |
| 11 | <i>Yea, all kings shall fall down before him: all nations shall serve him.</i> | May all kings bow down to him and all nations serve him. |
| 12 | <i>For he shall deliver the needy when he crieth; the poor also, and him that hath no helper.</i> | For he will deliver the needy who cry out, the afflicted who have no one to help. |

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| 13 <i>He shall spare the poor and needy, and shall save the souls of the needy.</i> | He will take pity on the weak and the needy and save the needy from death. |
| 14 <i>He shall redeem their soul from deceit and violence: and precious shall their blood be in his sight.</i> | He will rescue them from oppression and violence, for precious is their blood in his sight. |
| 15 <i>And he shall live, and to him shall be given of the gold of Sheba: prayer also shall be made for him continually; and daily shall he be praised.</i> | Long may he live! May gold from Sheba be given him. May people ever pray for him and bless him all day long. |
| 16 <i>There shall be an handful of corn in the earth upon the top of the mountains; the fruit thereof shall shake like Lebanon: and they of the city shall flourish like grass of the earth.</i> | May grain abound throughout the land; on the tops of the hills may it sway. May the crops flourish like Lebanon and thrive like the grass of the field. |
| 17 <i>His name shall endure for ever: his name shall be continued as long as the sun: and men shall be blessed in him: all nations shall call him blessed.</i> | May his name endure forever; may it continue as long as the sun. Then all nations will be blessed through him. They will call him blessed. |
| 18 <i>Blessed be the LORD God, the God of Israel, who only doeth wondrous things.</i> | Praise be to the LORD God, the God of Israel, who alone does marvelous deeds. |
| 19 <i>And blessed be his glorious name for ever: and let the whole earth be filled with his glory; Amen, and Amen.</i> | Praise be to His glorious name forever; may the whole earth be filled with His glory. Amen and Amen. |
| 20 <i>The prayers of David the son of Jesse are ended.</i> | This concludes the prayers of David son of Jesse. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 23:5-6; 1 Chr 22:12-13; 1 Chr 29:19; 1 Kgs 1:39-2:4; 2 Chr 1:10
v4 — Isa 11:4; Ezek 34:15-16; Ps 109:31; Zech 9:8-10

- v6 — Hos 6:3; Deut 32:2; 2 Sam 23:4
- v7 — Isa 2:4; Mal 4:2; Ps 92:12
- v8 — Zech 9:10; Ex 23:31
- v10 — Isa 60:6; Ps 68:29; Isa 49:7
- v12 — Job 29:12; Ps 102:17; Rev 3:17-18; Heb 7:25; Eccl 4:1
- v14 — Ps 116:15; Rev 19:2; Luke 1:68-75; 1 Thess 2:15-16; Ps 69:18
- v15 — 1 Kgs 10:14; Jude 1:25; Rev 5:8-14
- v17 — Isa 7:14; Matt 1:23; Ps 89:36; Gen 12:3; Luke 1:48
- v18 — Ps 41:13; Ps 106:48; 1 Chr 29:10; Ps 86:10; Ex 15:11
- v19 — Num 14:21; Matt 6:10; Hab 2:14; Ps 41:13; Rev 5:13

Psalm 73

A Psalm of Asaph.

The psalmist nearly stumbles when he envies the prosperity of the wicked, who seem to suffer no pain and grow fat with ease. But when he enters the sanctuary of God, he understands their end -- they are set in slippery places. He concludes that God is the strength of his heart and his portion forever.

- 1

Truly God is good to Israel, even to such as are of a clean heart.

Surely God is good to Israel, to those who are pure in heart.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Asaph** (AY-saf) — "gatherer" — A Levite musician appointed by David as chief singer before the ark of the covenant (1 Chr 16:4–5). Asaph is credited with twelve Psalms (50, 73–83). His descendants continued as temple musicians for centuries. These Psalms wrestle with the justice of God, the fate of the wicked, and the faithfulness of God to Israel.

- 2

But as for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well nigh slipped.

But as for me, my feet had almost slipped; I had nearly lost my foothold.
- 3

For I was envious at the foolish, when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.

For I envied the arrogant when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.
- 4

For there are no bands in their death: but their strength is firm.

They have no struggles; their bodies are healthy and strong.
- 5

They are not in trouble as other men; neither are they plagued like other men.

They are not in trouble as other men, nor are they plagued like other men.
- 6

Therefore pride compasseth them about as a chain; violence covereth them as a garment.

Therefore pride is their necklace; they clothe themselves with violence.

- 7 *Their eyes stand out with fatness: they have more than heart could wish.* From their callous hearts comes iniquity; their evil imaginations have no limits.
- 8 *They are corrupt, and speak wickedly concerning oppression: they speak loftily.* They scoff, and speak with malice; with arrogance they threaten oppression.
- 9 *They set their mouth against the heavens, and their tongue walketh through the earth.* Their mouths lay claim to heaven. Their tongues take possession of the earth.
- 10 *Therefore his people return hither: and waters of a full cup are wrung out to them.* Therefore their people turn to them and drink up waters in abundance.
- 11 *And they say, How doth God know? and is there knowledge in the most High?* They say, "How would God know? Does the Most High know anything?"
- 12 *Behold, these are the ungodly, who prosper in the world; they increase in riches.* This is what the wicked are like — always free of care, they go on amassing wealth.
- 13 *Verily I have cleansed my heart in vain, and washed my hands in innocence.* Surely in vain I have kept my heart pure and have washed my hands in innocence.
- 14 *For all the day long have I been plagued, and chastened every morning.* All day long I have been afflicted, and every morning brings new punishments.
- 15 *If I say, I will speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.* If I had spoken out like that, I would have betrayed your children.
- 16 *When I thought to know this, it was too painful for me;* When I tried to understand all this, it troubled me deeply
- 17 *Until I went into the sanctuary of God; then understood I their end.* till I entered the sanctuary of God; then I understood their final destiny.
- 18 *Surely thou didst set them in slippery places: thou castedst them down into destruction.* Surely you place them on slippery ground; you cast them down to ruin.

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| <p>19 <i>How are they brought into desolation, as in a moment! they are utterly consumed with terrors.</i></p> <p>20 <i>As a dream when one awaketh; so, O Lord, when thou awakest, thou shalt despise their image.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Thus my heart was grieved, and I was pricked in my reins.</i></p> <p>22 <i>So foolish was I, and ignorant: I was as a beast before thee.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Nevertheless I am continually with thee: thou hast holden me by my right hand.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Whom have I in heaven but thee? and there is none upon earth that I desire beside thee.</i></p> <p>26 <i>My flesh and my heart faileth: but God is the strength of my heart, and my portion for ever.</i></p> <p>27 <i>For, lo, they that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee.</i></p> <p>28 <i>But it is good for me to draw near to God: I have put my trust in the Lord GOD, that I may declare all thy works.</i></p> | <p>How suddenly are they destroyed, completely swept away by terrors!</p> <p>They are like a dream when one awakes; when you arise, Lord, you will despise them as fantasies.</p> <p>When my heart was grieved and my spirit embittered,</p> <p>I was senseless and ignorant; I was a brute beast before you.</p> <p>Yet I am always with you; you hold me by my right hand.</p> <p>You guide me with your counsel, and afterward you will take me into glory.</p> <p>Whom have I in heaven but you? And earth has nothing I desire besides you.</p> <p>My flesh and my heart may fail. But God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever.</p> <p>Those who are far from you will perish; you destroy all who are unfaithful to you.</p> <p>But it is good for me to draw near to God; I have put my trust in the Lord GOD, that I may declare all Your works.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 5:8; Ps 51:10; Luke 12:32; Ps 84:11; Jas 4:8
v2 — Ps 94:18; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 116:8; Ps 38:16
v3 — Job 21:7; Jer 12:1; Ps 37:7; Prov 23:17; Ps 37:1

- v13 — Ps 26:6; Job 21:15; Job 34:9
- v17 — Luke 12:20; Ps 77:13; Ps 27:4; Eccl 8:12-13
- v18 — Ps 35:6; Jer 23:12; Deut 32:35
- v23 — Isa 41:13; Ps 63:8; Matt 28:20; Heb 13:5; Ps 16:8
- v24 — Ps 32:8; Isa 58:11; Prov 3:5-6; Ps 48:14; Isa 48:17
- v25 — Phil 3:8; Ps 16:2; Ps 63:3; Ps 16:5; Isa 26:8-9
- v26 — 2 Cor 12:9-10; Isa 40:29-31; Ps 138:3; Ps 18:2; 2 Cor 4:8-10
- v27 — Jas 4:4; Ps 119:155; Ex 34:15
- v28 — Jas 4:8; Ps 40:5; Heb 10:19-22; Lam 3:25-26; Ps 65:4

Psalms 74

Maschil of Asaph.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Maschil** (MAS-kil) — A Hebrew term in Psalm titles meaning "a contemplation" or "a skillful psalm." It marks a Psalm meant for instruction or deep meditation — a teaching song.

The psalmist laments the destruction of the sanctuary, where enemies have roared, set up their ensigns, smashed the carved work, and burned God's dwelling place to the ground. He pleads with God to remember His covenant, arise, and no longer allow the foolish to reproach His name.

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| 1 | <i>O God, why hast thou cast us off for ever? why doth thine anger smoke against the sheep of thy pasture?</i> | O God, why have You rejected us forever? Why does Your anger smolder against the sheep of Your pasture? |
| 2 | <i>Remember thy congregation, which thou hast purchased of old; the rod of thine inheritance, which thou hast redeemed; this mount Zion, wherein thou hast dwelt.</i> | Remember the nation you purchased long ago, the people of your inheritance, whom you redeemed — Mount Zion, where you lived. |
| 3 | <i>Lift up thy feet unto the perpetual desolations; even all that the enemy hath done wickedly in the sanctuary.</i> | Turn your steps toward these everlasting ruins, all this destruction the enemy has brought on the sanctuary. |
| 4 | <i>Thine enemies roar in the midst of thy congregations; they set up their ensigns for signs.</i> | Your enemies roar in the midst of your congregations; they set up their ensigns for signs. |

- 5 *A man was famous according as he had lifted up axes upon the thick trees.* They behaved like men wielding axes to cut through a thicket of trees.
- 6 *But now they break down the carved work thereof at once with axes and hammers.* They smashed all the carved paneling with their axes and hatchets.
- 7 *They have cast fire into thy sanctuary, they have defiled by casting down the dwelling place of thy name to the ground.* They burned your sanctuary to the ground; they defiled the dwelling place of your Name.
- 8 *They said in their hearts, Let us destroy them together: they have burned up all the synagogues of God in the land.* They said in their hearts, "We will crush them completely!" They burned every place where God was worshiped in the land.
- 9 *We see not our signs: there is no more any prophet: neither is there among us any that knoweth how long.* We are given no signs from God; no prophets are left, and none of us knows how long this will be.
- 10 *O God, how long shall the adversary reproach? shall the enemy blaspheme thy name for ever?* How long will the enemy mock you, God? Will the foe revile your name forever?
- 11 *Why withdrawest thou thy hand, even thy right hand? pluck it out of thy bosom.* Why do you hold back your hand, your right hand? Take it from the folds of your garment and destroy them!
- 12 *For God is my King of old, working salvation in the midst of the earth.* But God is my King from long ago; He brings salvation on the earth.
- 13 *Thou didst divide the sea by thy strength: thou brakest the heads of the dragons in the waters.* It was you who split open the sea by your power; you broke the heads of the monster in the waters.
- 14 *Thou brakest the heads of leviathan in pieces, and gavest him to be meat to the people inhabiting the wilderness.* It was you who crushed the heads of Leviathan and gave it as food to the creatures of the desert.
- 15 *Thou didst cleave the fountain and the flood: thou driedst up mighty rivers.* It was you who opened up springs and streams; you dried up the ever-flowing rivers.

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| <p>16 <i>The day is thine, the night also is thine: thou hast prepared the light and the sun.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Thou hast set all the borders of the earth: thou hast made summer and winter.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Remember this, that the enemy hath reproached, O LORD, and that the foolish people have blasphemed thy name.</i></p> <p>19 <i>O deliver not the soul of thy turtledove unto the multitude of the wicked: forget not the congregation of thy poor for ever.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Have respect unto the covenant: for the dark places of the earth are full of the habitations of cruelty.</i></p> <p>21 <i>O let not the oppressed return ashamed: let the poor and needy praise thy name.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Arise, O God, plead thine own cause: remember how the foolish man reproacheth thee daily.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Forget not the voice of thine enemies: the tumult of those that rise up against thee increaseth continually.</i></p> | <p>The day is yours, and yours also the night; you established the sun and moon.</p> <p>It was you who set all the boundaries of the earth; you made both summer and winter.</p> <p>Remember how the enemy has mocked you, LORD, how foolish people have reviled Your name.</p> <p>Do not hand over the life of Your dove to wild beasts; do not forget the lives of Your afflicted people forever.</p> <p>Have regard for Your covenant, because haunts of violence fill the dark places of the land.</p> <p>Do not let the oppressed retreat in disgrace; may the poor and needy praise Your name.</p> <p>Rise up, O God, and defend Your cause; remember how fools mock You all day long.</p> <p>Do not ignore the clamor of Your adversaries, the uproar of Your enemies, which rises continually.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 29:20; Ps 79:13; Ps 100:3; Ps 44:9; Ps 95:7
- v2 — Jer 10:16; Ex 15:16; Ex 15:13; Deut 32:9
- v4 — Lam 2:7; Matt 24:15
- v9 — Ezek 7:26; Amos 8:11; 1 Sam 3:1
- v11 — Lam 2:3
- v12 — Isa 33:22; Ps 44:4

- v13 — Ex 14:21; Ps 78:13
- v14 — Isa 27:1; Ps 72:9; Ps 104:25-26; Job 41:1-34; Num 14:9
- v16 — Matt 5:45; Gen 1:3-5; Ps 136:7-9; Ps 104:19
- v17 — Deut 32:8; Acts 17:26; Acts 14:17; Gen 8:22
- v19 — Song 2:14; Jas 2:5-6
- v20 — Ps 106:45; Gen 17:7-8; Heb 8:10

Psalm 75

To the chief Musician, Altaschith, A Psalm or Song of Asaph.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Altaschith* (al-TAS-kith) — A Hebrew term in Psalm titles meaning "Do not destroy." It may indicate the tune to which the Psalm was sung, or a plea that forms the theme of the song.

The people give thanks because God's name is near and His wondrous works declare it. God speaks, warning the arrogant not to lift up the horn, for promotion comes neither from the east nor the west -- it is God who judges, putting down one and setting up another. The wicked shall drink the dregs of His cup of wrath.

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| 1 | <i>Unto thee, O God, do we give thanks, unto thee do we give thanks: for that thy name is near thy wondrous works declare.</i> | We praise You, God, we praise You, for Your Name is near; people tell of Your wonderful deeds. |
| 2 | <i>When I shall receive the congregation I will judge uprightly.</i> | You say, "I choose the appointed time; it is I who judge with equity. |
| 3 | <i>The earth and all the inhabitants thereof are dissolved: I bear up the pillars of it. Selah.</i> | When the earth and all its people quake, it is I who hold its pillars firm. |
| 4 | <i>I said unto the fools, Deal not foolishly: and to the wicked, Lift not up the horn:</i> | To the arrogant I say, 'Boast no more,' and to the wicked, 'Do not lift up your horns. |
| 5 | <i>Lift not up your horn on high: speak not with a stiff neck.</i> | Do not lift your horns against heaven; do not speak so defiantly.' " |
| 6 | <i>For promotion cometh neither from the east, nor from the west, nor from the south.</i> | No one from the east or the west or from the desert can exalt themselves. |
| 7 | <i>But God is the judge: he putteth down one, and setteth up another.</i> | It is God Who judges: He brings one down, He exalts another. |

8	<i>For in the hand of the LORD there is a cup, and the wine is red; it is full of mixture; and he poureth out of the same: but the dregs thereof, all the wicked of the earth shall wring them out, and drink them.</i>	In the hand of the LORD is a cup full of foaming wine mixed with spices; He pours it out. All the wicked of the earth drink it down to its very dregs.
9	<i>But I will declare for ever; I will sing praises to the God of Jacob.</i>	As for me, I will declare this forever; I will sing praise to the God of Jacob,
10	<i>All the horns of the wicked also will I cut off; but the horns of the righteous shall be exalted.</i>	who says, "I will cut off the horns of all the wicked, but the horns of the righteous will be lifted up."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 145:18; Ps 138:2; Jer 10:6; Deut 4:7
- v2 — Eccl 3:17; Acts 17:31; Acts 1:7; John 7:6; Ps 102:13
- v3 — 1 Sam 2:8; Isa 24:19
- v4 — Zech 1:21
- v5 — Acts 7:51
- v6 — Ps 3:3
- v7 — Luke 1:52; Dan 2:21-22; Ps 147:6; Ps 113:7-8; Ps 50:6
- v8 — Job 21:20; Jer 25:15; Ps 11:6; Rev 16:19; Rev 14:9-10
- v10 — Ps 92:10; Ps 89:17; Ps 101:8; Ps 148:14; Jer 48:25

Psalm 76

To the chief Musician on Neginoth, A Psalm or Song of Asaph.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Neginoth* (NEG-ih-noth) — A Hebrew term in Psalm titles meaning "stringed instruments." It directs the musicians to accompany the Psalm with harps, lyres, or other stringed instruments.

The psalmist celebrates God's victory from Zion, where He broke the weapons of war and judged the earth. All are called to fear the God who cuts off the spirit of rulers and terrifies the kings of the earth.

1	<i>In Judah is God known: his name is great in Israel.</i>	God is renowned in Judah; in Israel His name is great.
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| 2 | <i>In Salem also is his tabernacle, and his dwelling place in Zion.</i> | his tent is in Salem, his dwelling place in Zion. |
| 3 | <i>There brake he the arrows of the bow, the shield, and the sword, and the battle. Selah.</i> | There he broke the flashing arrows, the shields and the swords, the weapons of war. |
| 4 | <i>Thou art more glorious and excellent than the mountains of prey.</i> | You are radiant with light, more majestic than mountains rich with game. |
| 5 | <i>The stouthearted are spoiled, they have slept their sleep: and none of the men of might have found their hands.</i> | The valiant lie plundered, they sleep their last sleep; not one of the warriors can lift his hands. |
| 6 | <i>At thy rebuke, O God of Jacob, both the chariot and horse are cast into a dead sleep.</i> | At your rebuke, God of Jacob, both horse and chariot lie still. |
| 7 | <i>Thou, even thou, art to be feared: and who may stand in thy sight when once thou art angry?</i> | It is you alone who are to be feared. Who can stand before you when you are angry? |
| 8 | <i>Thou didst cause judgment to be heard from heaven; the earth feared, and was still,</i> | From heaven you pronounced judgment, and the land feared and was quiet — |
| 9 | <i>When God arose to judgment, to save all the meek of the earth. Selah.</i> | when You, God, rose up to judge, to save all the afflicted of the land. |
| 10 | <i>Surely the wrath of man shall praise thee: the remainder of wrath shalt thou restrain.</i> | Human wrath brings you praise, and the survivors of your wrath are restrained. |
| 11 | <i>Vow, and pay unto the LORD your God: let all that be round about him bring presents unto him that ought to be feared.</i> | Make vows to the LORD Your God and fulfill them; let all the neighboring lands bring gifts to the One to be feared. |
| 12 | <i>He shall cut off the spirit of princes: he is terrible to the kings of the earth.</i> | He breaks the spirit of rulers; He is feared by the kings of the earth. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 17:23; Dan 4:1-2
- v2 — Gen 14:18; Isa 12:6
- v3 — Ps 46:9
- v5 — Nah 3:18; Ps 13:3
- v6 — Ex 15:1
- v7 — Nah 1:6
- v8 — 2 Chr 20:29-30
- v10 — Rom 9:17
- v11 — Eccl 5:4-6; Ps 50:14; Ps 68:29
- v12 — Zeph 3:6

Psalm 77

To the chief Musician, to Jeduthun, A Psalm of Asaph.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jeduthun** (jeh-DOO-thun) — "praising" — One of three chief musicians appointed by David to lead worship (alongside Asaph and Heman). His name appears in the titles of Psalms 39, 62, and 77, likely indicating a musical style, choir, or tune associated with his tradition.

The psalmist cries out to God in deep distress, unable to sleep or be comforted, wondering whether the Lord has forgotten His mercy. He turns from despair to remembrance, recalling God's mighty works at the Red Sea and His faithful leading of Israel through Moses and Aaron.

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| 1 | <i>I cried unto God with my voice, even unto God with my voice; and he gave ear unto me.</i> | I cried out to God for help; I cried out to God to hear me. |
| 2 | <i>In the day of my trouble I sought the Lord: my sore ran in the night, and ceased not: my soul refused to be comforted.</i> | When I was in distress, I sought the Lord; at night I stretched out untiring hands. I would not be comforted. |
| 3 | <i>I remembered God, and was troubled: I complained, and my spirit was overwhelmed. Selah.</i> | I remembered you, God. I groaned; I meditated, and my spirit grew faint. |
| 4 | <i>Thou holdest mine eyes waking: I am so troubled that I cannot speak.</i> | You kept my eyes from closing; I was too troubled to speak. |
| 5 | <i>I have considered the days of old, the years of ancient times.</i> | I thought about the former days, the years of long ago; |

- 6 *I call to remembrance my song in the night: I commune with mine own heart: and my spirit made diligent search.* I remembered my songs in the night. My heart meditated and my spirit asked:
- 7 *Will the Lord cast off for ever? and will he be favourable no more?* "Will the Lord reject forever? Will He never show His favor again?
- 8 *Is his mercy clean gone for ever? doth his promise fail for evermore?* Has his mercy vanished forever? Has his promise failed for all time?
- 9 *Hath God forgotten to be gracious? hath he in anger shut up his tender mercies? Selah.* Has God forgotten to be merciful? Has He in anger withheld His compassion?"
- 10 *And I said, This is my infirmity: but I will remember the years of the right hand of the most High.* Then I thought, "To this I will appeal: the years when the Most High stretched out His right hand.
- 11 *I will remember the works of the LORD: surely I will remember thy wonders of old.* I will remember the deeds of the LORD; yes, I will remember Your miracles of long ago.
- 12 *I will meditate also of all thy work, and talk of thy doings.* I will consider all Your works and meditate on all Your mighty deeds."
- 13 *Thy way, O God, is in the sanctuary: who is so great a God as our God?* Your ways, God, are holy. What god is as great as our God?
- 14 *Thou art the God that doest wonders: thou hast declared thy strength among the people.* You are the God Who performs miracles; You display Your power among the peoples.
- 15 *Thou hast with thine arm redeemed thy people, the sons of Jacob and Joseph. Selah.* With your mighty arm you redeemed your people, the descendants of Jacob and Joseph.
- 16 *The waters saw thee, O God, the waters saw thee; they were afraid: the depths also were troubled.* The waters saw You, God, the waters saw You and writhed; the very depths were convulsed.
- 17 *The clouds poured out water: the skies sent out a sound: thine arrows also went abroad.* The clouds poured down water, the heavens resounded with thunder; your arrows flashed back and forth.

18	<i>The voice of thy thunder was in the heaven: the lightnings lightened the world: the earth trembled and shook.</i>	Your thunder was heard in the whirlwind, your lightning lit up the world; the earth trembled and quaked.
19	<i>Thy way is in the sea, and thy path in the great waters, and thy footsteps are not known.</i>	Your path led through the sea, your way through the mighty waters, though your footprints were not seen.
20	<i>Thou leddest thy people like a flock by the hand of Moses and Aaron.</i>	You led your people like a flock by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 3:4; Ps 142:1-3; Ps 50:1
- v2 — Ps 50:15; Gen 37:35; Isa 26:9; Isa 26:16; Heb 5:7
- v6 — Ps 42:8; Ps 4:4; Ps 139:23-24; Lam 3:40; Eccl 1:16
- v7 — Ps 85:1; Lam 3:31-32; Rom 11:1-2; Ps 89:46; Ps 85:5
- v11 — Ps 143:5; Ps 105:5; 1 Chr 16:12; Isa 5:12; Ps 78:11
- v12 — Ps 71:24; Ps 145:11; Deut 6:7; Ps 105:2
- v13 — Ex 15:11; Ps 73:17; Isa 40:25; Ps 89:6-8; Deut 32:31
- v14 — Dan 6:27; Ps 136:4; Ex 15:11; Ex 13:14; Isa 51:9
- v15 — Ex 6:6; Deut 9:29; Isa 63:9
- v16 — Ex 14:21; Josh 3:15-16; Hab 3:15; Ps 114:3-6
- v19 — Ex 14:28; Ps 29:10; Neh 9:11; Hab 3:15
- v20 — Ex 13:21; Ex 14:19; Ps 78:52; Isa 63:11-12; Ps 80:1

Psalm 78

Maschil of Asaph.

Asaph recounts Israel's history from the exodus through the wilderness to David's kingship, tracing a pattern of God's mighty deliverance met by the people's stubborn rebellion. Despite Israel's repeated unfaithfulness, God shows compassion again and again, finally choosing Judah, Zion, and David to shepherd His people.

1	<i>Give ear, O my people, to my law: incline your ears to the words of my mouth.</i>	My people, hear my teaching; listen to the words of my mouth.
2	<i>I will open my mouth in a parable: I will utter dark sayings of old:</i>	I will open my mouth with a parable; I will utter hidden things, things from of old —

- 3 *Which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us.* which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us.
- 4 *We will not hide them from their children, shewing to the generation to come the praises of the LORD, and his strength, and his wonderful works that he hath done.* We will not hide them from their descendants; we will tell the next generation the praiseworthy deeds of the LORD, His power, and the wonders He has done.
- 5 *For he established a testimony in Jacob, and appointed a law in Israel, which he commanded our fathers, that they should make them known to their children:* For he established a testimony in Jacob, and appointed a law in Israel, which he commanded our fathers, that they should make them known to their children,
- 6 *That the generation to come might know them, even the children which should be born; who should arise and declare them to their children:* so the next generation would know them, even the children yet to be born. They in turn would tell their children.
- 7 *That they might set their hope in God, and not forget the works of God, but keep his commandments:* Then they would put their trust in God and would not forget His deeds but would keep His commands.
- 8 *And might not be as their fathers, a stubborn and rebellious generation; a generation that set not their heart aright, and whose spirit was not stedfast with God.* They would not be like their ancestors — a stubborn and rebellious generation, whose hearts were not loyal to God, whose spirits were not faithful to Him.
- 9 *The children of Ephraim, being armed, and carrying bows, turned back in the day of battle.* The men of Ephraim, though armed with bows, turned back on the day of battle;
- 10 *They kept not the covenant of God, and refused to walk in his law;* they did not keep God's covenant and refused to live by His law.
- 11 *And forgat his works, and his wonders that he had shewed them.* They forgot what he had done, the wonders he had shown them.
- 12 *Marvellous things did he in the sight of their fathers, in the land of Egypt, in the field of Zoan.* He did miracles in the sight of their ancestors in the land of Egypt, in the region of Zoan.

- 13 *He divided the sea, and caused them to pass through; and he made the waters to stand as an heap.* He divided the sea and led them through; he made the water stand up like a wall.
- 14 *In the daytime also he led them with a cloud, and all the night with a light of fire.* He guided them with the cloud by day and with light from the fire all night.
- 15 *He clave the rocks in the wilderness, and gave them drink as out of the great depths.* He split the rocks in the wilderness and gave them water as abundant as the seas;
- 16 *He brought streams also out of the rock, and caused waters to run down like rivers.* he brought streams out of a rocky crag and made water flow down like rivers.
- 17 *And they sinned yet more against him by provoking the most High in the wilderness.* But they continued to sin against Him, rebelling in the wilderness against the Most High.
- 18 *And they tempted God in their heart by asking meat for their lust.* They willfully put God to the test by demanding the food they craved.
- 19 *Yea, they spake against God; they said, Can God furnish a table in the wilderness?* They spoke against God; they said, "Can God really spread a table in the wilderness?"
- 20 *Behold, he smote the rock, that the waters gushed out, and the streams overflowed; can he give bread also? can he provide flesh for his people?* True, He struck the rock, and water gushed out, streams flowed abundantly, but can He also give us bread? Can He supply meat for His people?"
- 21 *Therefore the LORD heard this, and was wroth: so a fire was kindled against Jacob, and anger also came up against Israel;* When the LORD heard them, He was furious; His fire broke out against Jacob. His wrath rose against Israel,
- 22 *Because they believed not in God, and trusted not in his salvation:* for they did not believe in God or trust in His deliverance.
- 23 *Though he had commanded the clouds from above, and opened the doors of heaven,* Yet He gave a command to the skies above and opened the doors of the heavens;

- 24 *And had rained down manna upon them to eat, and had given them of the corn of heaven.* he rained down manna for the people to eat, he gave them the grain of heaven.
- 25 *Man did eat angels' food: he sent them meat to the full.* Man ate angels' food; He sent them meat to the full.
- 26 *He caused an east wind to blow in the heaven: and by his power he brought in the south wind.* He let loose the east wind from the heavens and by His power made the south wind blow.
- 27 *He rained flesh also upon them as dust, and feathered fowls like as the sand of the sea:* He rained meat down on them like dust, birds like sand on the seashore.
- 28 *And he let it fall in the midst of their camp, round about their habitations.* He made them come down inside their camp, all around their tents.
- 29 *So they did eat, and were well filled: for he gave them their own desire;* They ate till they were gorged — he had given them what they craved.
- 30 *They were not estranged from their lust. But while their meat was yet in their mouths,* But before they turned from what they craved, even while the food was still in their mouths,
- 31 *The wrath of God came upon them, and slew the fattest of them, and smote down the chosen men of Israel.* God's anger rose against them; He put to death the sturdiest among them, cutting down the young men of Israel.
- 32 *For all this they sinned still, and believed not for his wondrous works.* In spite of all this, they kept on sinning; in spite of His wonders, they did not believe.
- 33 *Therefore their days did he consume in vanity, and their years in trouble.* So He ended their days in futility and their years in terror.
- 34 *When he slew them, then they sought him: and they returned and enquired early after God.* Whenever God slew them, they would seek Him; they eagerly turned to Him again.
- 35 *And they remembered that God was their rock, and the high God their redeemer.* They remembered that God was their Rock, that God Most High was their Redeemer.

- 36 *Nevertheless they did flatter him with their mouth, and they lied unto him with their tongues.* But then they would flatter Him with their mouths, lying to Him with their tongues;
- 37 *For their heart was not right with him, neither were they stedfast in his covenant.* their hearts were not loyal to Him, they were not faithful to His covenant.
- 38 *But he, being full of compassion, forgave their iniquity, and destroyed them not: yea, many a time turned he his anger away, and did not stir up all his wrath.* Yet He was merciful; He forgave their iniquities and did not destroy them. Time after time He restrained His anger and did not stir up His full wrath.
- 39 *For he remembered that they were but flesh; a wind that passeth away, and cometh not again.* He remembered that they were but flesh, a passing breeze that does not return.
- 40 *How oft did they provoke him in the wilderness, and grieve him in the desert!* How often they rebelled against Him in the wilderness and grieved Him in the wasteland!
- 41 *Yea, they turned back and tempted God, and limited the Holy One of Israel.* Again and again they put God to the test; they vexed the Holy One of Israel.
- 42 *They remembered not his hand, nor the day when he delivered them from the enemy.* They did not remember His power — the day He redeemed them from the oppressor,
- 43 *How he had wrought his signs in Egypt, and his wonders in the field of Zoan:* the day He displayed His signs in Egypt, His wonders in the region of Zoan.
- 44 *And had turned their rivers into blood; and their floods, that they could not drink.* He turned their river into blood; they could not drink from their streams.
- 45 *He sent divers sorts of flies among them, which devoured them; and frogs, which destroyed them.* He sent swarms of flies that devoured them, and frogs that devastated them.

- 46 *He gave also their increase unto the caterpillar, and their labour unto the locust.* He gave their crops to the grasshopper, their produce to the locust.
- 47 *He destroyed their vines with hail, and their sycamore trees with frost.* He destroyed their vines with hail and their sycamore-figs with sleet.
- 48 *He gave up their cattle also to the hail, and their flocks to hot thunderbolts.* He gave over their cattle to the hail, their livestock to bolts of lightning.
- 49 *He cast upon them the fierceness of his anger, wrath, and indignation, and trouble, by sending evil angels among them.* He unleashed against them His hot anger, His wrath, indignation and hostility — a band of destroying angels.
- 50 *He made a way to his anger; he spared not their soul from death, but gave their life over to the pestilence;* He prepared a path for His anger; He did not spare them from death but gave them over to the plague.
- 51 *And smote all the firstborn in Egypt; the chief of their strength in the tabernacles of Ham:* He struck down all the firstborn of Egypt, the firstfruits of manhood in the tents of Ham.
- 52 *But made his own people to go forth like sheep, and guided them in the wilderness like a flock.* But he brought his people out like a flock; he led them like sheep through the wilderness.
- 53 *And he led them on safely, so that they feared not: but the sea overwhelmed their enemies.* He guided them safely, so they were unafraid; but the sea engulfed their enemies.
- 54 *And he brought them to the border of his sanctuary, even to this mountain, which his right hand had purchased.* so he brought them to the border of his holy land, to the hill country his right hand had taken.
- 55 *He cast out the heathen also before them, and divided them an inheritance by line, and made the tribes of Israel to dwell in their tents.* He drove out nations before them and allotted their lands to them as an inheritance; he settled the tribes of Israel in their homes.
- 56 *Yet they tempted and provoked the most high God, and kept not his testimonies:* But they put God to the test and rebelled against the Most High; they did not keep His statutes.

- 57 *But turned back, and dealt
unfaithfully like their fathers: they
were turned aside like a deceitful bow.* Like their ancestors they were disloyal
and faithless, as unreliable as a faulty
bow.
- 58 *For they provoked him to anger with
their high places, and moved him to
jealousy with their graven images.* They angered Him with their high
places; they aroused His jealousy with
their idols.
- 59 *When God heard this, he was wroth,
and greatly abhorred Israel:* When God heard them, He was
furious; He rejected Israel completely.
- 60 *So that he forsook the tabernacle of
Shiloh, the tent which he placed
among men;* So that He forsook the tabernacle of
Shiloh, the tent which He placed
among men,
- 61 *And delivered his strength into
captivity, and his glory into the
enemy's hand.* He sent the ark of His might into
captivity, His splendor into the hands
of the enemy.
- 62 *He gave his people over also unto the
sword; and was wroth with his
inheritance.* He gave His people over to the sword;
He was furious with His inheritance.
- 63 *The fire consumed their young men;
and their maidens were not given to
marriage.* Fire consumed their young men. Their
young women had no wedding songs;
- 64 *Their priests fell by the sword; and
their widows made no lamentation.* their priests were put to the sword.
Their widows could not weep.
- 65 *Then the Lord awaked as one out of
sleep, and like a mighty man that
shouteth by reason of wine.* Then the Lord awoke as if from sleep,
as a warrior wakes from the stupor of
wine.
- 66 *And he smote his enemies in the
hinder parts: he put them to a
perpetual reproach.* He beat back His enemies; He put
them to everlasting shame.
- 67 *Moreover he refused the tabernacle of
Joseph, and chose not the tribe of
Ephraim:* Then he rejected the tents of Joseph, he
did not choose the tribe of Ephraim;
- 68 *But chose the tribe of Judah, the
mount Zion which he loved.* but he chose the tribe of Judah, Mount
Zion, which he loved.

69	<i>And he built his sanctuary like high palaces, like the earth which he hath established for ever.</i>	He built his sanctuary like the heights, like the earth that he established forever.
70	<i>He chose David also his servant, and took him from the sheepfolds:</i>	He chose David his servant and took him from the sheep pens;
71	<i>From following the ewes great with young he brought him to feed Jacob his people, and Israel his inheritance.</i>	from tending the sheep he brought him to be the shepherd of his people Jacob, of Israel his inheritance.
72	<i>So he fed them according to the integrity of his heart; and guided them by the skilfulness of his hands.</i>	David shepherded them with integrity of heart; with skillful hands he led them.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 51:4; Isa 55:3; Judg 5:3; Ps 50:7; 2 Chr 15:1-16
- v2 — Matt 13:34-35; Matt 13:11-13; Mark 4:34; Ps 49:4; Prov 1:6
- v4 — Deut 11:19; Deut 4:9; Ps 145:4-6; Joel 1:3; Deut 6:7
- v5 — Eph 6:4; Gen 18:19; Ps 81:5; Deut 6:7; Deut 4:45
- v7 — Deut 5:29; Rev 14:12; Deut 4:9; 1 John 5:3
- v8 — Ps 78:37; Ex 32:9; Ezek 20:18; 2 Kgs 17:14; Deut 31:27
- v15 — Ps 105:41; Num 20:11; Ex 17:6; 1 Cor 10:4; Ps 114:8
- v38 — Isa 48:9; Ezek 20:17; Num 14:18-20; Ezek 20:13-14; Isa 44:21-22
- v41 — Num 14:22; Heb 3:8-11; Acts 7:39; Deut 6:16; Ps 78:19-20
- v42 — Judg 8:34; Jer 32:21; Ex 14:12; Ps 78:11; Ps 136:10-15
- v51 — Ps 105:23; Ps 135:8; Ps 106:22; Ps 105:36; Ps 136:10
- v53 — Ex 14:19-20; Ex 15:10; Heb 11:29; Ps 136:15; Ex 14:15

Psalm 79

A Psalm of Asaph.

The psalmist laments the destruction of Jerusalem and the temple by invading nations, crying out to God over the unburied dead and the mockery of enemies. He pleads for God to pour out His wrath on the nations and to show mercy to His suffering people for the sake of His name.

1	<i>O God, the heathen are come into thine inheritance; thy holy temple have they defiled; they have laid Jerusalem on heaps.</i>	O God, the nations have invaded your inheritance; they have defiled Your holy temple, they have reduced Jerusalem to rubble.
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| 2 <i>The dead bodies of thy servants have they given to be meat unto the fowls of the heaven, the flesh of thy saints unto the beasts of the earth.</i> | They have left the dead bodies of your servants as food for the birds of the sky, the flesh of your own people for the animals of the wild. |
| 3 <i>Their blood have they shed like water round about Jerusalem; and there was none to bury them.</i> | They have poured out blood like water all around Jerusalem, and there is no one to bury the dead. |
| 4 <i>We are become a reproach to our neighbours, a scorn and derision to them that are round about us.</i> | We are objects of contempt to our neighbors, of scorn and derision to those around us. |
| 5 <i>How long, LORD? wilt thou be angry for ever? shall thy jealousy burn like fire?</i> | How long, LORD? Will You be angry forever? How long will Your jealousy burn like fire? |
| 6 <i>Pour out thy wrath upon the heathen that have not known thee, and upon the kingdoms that have not called upon thy name.</i> | Pour out Your wrath on the nations that do not acknowledge you, on the kingdoms that do not call on Your name; |
| 7 <i>For they have devoured Jacob, and laid waste his dwelling place.</i> | for they have devoured Jacob and devastated his homeland. |
| 8 <i>O remember not against us former iniquities: let thy tender mercies speedily prevent us: for we are brought very low.</i> | Do not hold against us the sins of past generations; may your mercy come quickly to meet us, for we are in desperate need. |
| 9 <i>Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name: and deliver us, and purge away our sins, for thy name's sake.</i> | Help us, God our Savior, for the glory of your name; deliver us and forgive our sins for your name's sake. |
| 10 <i>Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is their God? let him be known among the heathen in our sight by the revenging of the blood of thy servants which is shed.</i> | Why should the nations say, "Where is their God?" Before our eyes, make known among the nations that you avenge the outpoured blood of your servants. |

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| <p>11 <i>Let the sighing of the prisoner come before thee; according to the greatness of thy power preserve thou those that are appointed to die;</i></p> <p>12 <i>And render unto our neighbours sevenfold into their bosom their reproach, wherewith they have reproached thee, O Lord.</i></p> <p>13 <i>So we thy people and sheep of thy pasture will give thee thanks for ever: we will shew forth thy praise to all generations.</i></p> | <p>May the groans of the prisoners come before you; with your strong arm preserve those condemned to die.</p> <p>Pay back into the laps of our neighbors seven times the contempt they have hurled at you, Lord.</p> <p>Then we your people, the sheep of your pasture, will praise you forever; from generation to generation we will proclaim your praise.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 7:33; Jer 34:20
- v4 — Ps 80:6
- v5 — Ps 89:46; Ps 74:1; Ps 85:5
- v6 — Jer 10:25; 2 Thess 1:8; Ps 14:4
- v7 — Jer 51:34-35
- v8 — Isa 64:9; Ps 142:6; Ps 116:6; Rev 18:5; Ps 21:3
- v9 — Jer 14:7; 2 Chr 14:11; Ps 25:11; Jer 14:21; Isa 48:9
- v11 — Ps 102:20; Isa 33:2; Ps 146:6-7; Isa 42:7; Ps 12:5
- v12 — Jer 32:18; Gen 4:15
- v13 — Ps 95:7; Isa 43:21; Ps 100:3; Ps 74:1

Psalm 80

The psalmist pleads with the Shepherd of Israel to shine forth and restore His people, using the image of a vine transplanted from Egypt that once filled the land but now lies broken and burned. The repeated refrain begs God to turn them again and cause His countenance to shine, that they may be saved.

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| <p>1 <i>Give ear, O Shepherd of Israel, thou that leadest Joseph like a flock; thou that dwellest between the cherubims, shine forth.</i></p> | <p>Hear us, Shepherd of Israel, you who lead Joseph like a flock. You who sit enthroned between the cherubim, shine forth</p> |
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| 2 <i>Before Ephraim and Benjamin and Manasseh stir up thy strength, and come and save us.</i> | before Ephraim, Benjamin and Manasseh. Awaken your might; come and save us. |
| 3 <i>Turn us again, O God, and cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.</i> | Turn us again, O God, and cause Your countenance to shine; and we shall be saved. |
| 4 <i>O LORD God of hosts, how long wilt thou be angry against the prayer of thy people?</i> | O LORD God of hosts, how long will You be angry against the prayer of Your people? |
| 5 <i>Thou feedest them with the bread of tears; and givest them tears to drink in great measure.</i> | You have fed them with the bread of tears; You have made them drink tears by the bowlful. |
| 6 <i>Thou makest us a strife unto our neighbours: and our enemies laugh among themselves.</i> | You have made us an object of contention to our neighbors, and our enemies mock us. |
| 7 <i>Turn us again, O God of hosts, and cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.</i> | Turn us again, O God of hosts, and cause Your countenance to shine; and we shall be saved. |
| 8 <i>Thou hast brought a vine out of Egypt: thou hast cast out the heathen, and planted it.</i> | You transplanted a vine from Egypt; You drove out the nations and planted it. |
| 9 <i>Thou preparedst room before it, and didst cause it to take deep root, and it filled the land.</i> | You cleared the ground for it. It took root and filled the land. |
| 10 <i>The hills were covered with the shadow of it, and the boughs thereof were like the goodly cedars.</i> | The mountains were covered with its shade, the mighty cedars with its branches. |
| 11 <i>She sent out her boughs unto the sea, and her branches unto the river.</i> | Its branches reached as far as the Sea, its shoots as far as the River. |
| 12 <i>Why hast thou then broken down her hedges, so that all they which pass by the way do pluck her?</i> | Why have You broken down its walls so that all who pass by pick its grapes? |

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| 13 <i>The boar out of the wood doth waste it, and the wild beast of the field doth devour it.</i> | Boars from the forest ravage it, and insects from the fields feed on it. |
| 14 <i>Return, we beseech thee, O God of hosts: look down from heaven, and behold, and visit this vine;</i> | Return, we ask, O God of hosts; look down from heaven, see, and visit this vine, |
| 15 <i>And the vineyard which thy right hand hath planted, and the branch that thou madest strong for thyself.</i> | the root Your right hand has planted, the son You have raised up for Yourself. |
| 16 <i>It is burned with fire, it is cut down: they perish at the rebuke of thy countenance.</i> | It is burned with fire, it is cut down; they perish at the rebuke of Your countenance. |
| 17 <i>Let thy hand be upon the man of thy right hand, upon the son of man whom thou madest strong for thyself.</i> | Let your hand rest on the man at your right hand, the son of man you have raised up for yourself. |
| 18 <i>So will not we go back from thee: quicken us, and we will call upon thy name.</i> | Then we will not turn away from you; revive us. We will call on your name. |
| 19 <i>Turn us again, O LORD God of hosts, cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.</i> | Turn us again, O LORD God of hosts, cause Your countenance to shine; and we shall be saved. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 21:23; Ps 50:2; Ps 77:20; Ps 99:1; 1 Pet 2:25
v2 — Ps 35:23; Num 2:18-24
v3 — Lam 5:21; Num 6:25-26; Ps 85:4; Ps 80:7; Ps 80:19
v4 — Ps 85:5
v5 — Isa 30:20; Ps 42:3; Ps 102:9
v7 — Ps 51:10; Ps 80:19; Isa 64:5
v8 — Jer 2:21; Ps 44:2; Ezek 17:6; Jer 12:10; Jer 18:9-10
v12 — Isa 5:5
v14 — Isa 63:15
v16 — Ps 39:11; John 15:6
v18 — Ps 119:25; Ps 119:107; Phil 2:12-13; Ps 119:154; Ps 119:40
v19 — Jer 3:22-23; Ps 27:4; Ps 80:3

Psalm 81

God calls Israel to joyful worship, reminding them of His deliverance from Egypt and His longing to bless them. He laments that His people would not listen, and declares that if they had obeyed, He would have subdued their enemies and fed them with the finest wheat and honey from the rock.

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| 1 <i>Sing aloud unto God our strength:
make a joyful noise unto the God of
Jacob.</i> | Sing for joy to God our strength; shout
aloud to the God of Jacob! |
| 2 <i>Take a psalm, and bring hither the
timbrel, the pleasant harp with the
psaltery.</i> | Begin the music, strike the timbrel,
play the melodious harp and lyre. |
| 3 <i>Blow up the trumpet in the new moon,
in the time appointed, on our solemn
feast day.</i> | Sound the ram's horn at the New
Moon, and when the moon is full, on
the day of our festival; |
| 4 <i>For this was a statute for Israel, and a
law of the God of Jacob.</i> | this is a decree for Israel, an ordinance
of the God of Jacob. |
| 5 <i>This he ordained in Joseph for a
testimony, when he went out through
the land of Egypt: where I heard a
language that I understood not.</i> | When God went out against Egypt, He
established it as a statute for Joseph. I
heard an unknown voice say: |
| 6 <i>I removed his shoulder from the
burden: his hands were delivered
from the pots.</i> | "I removed the burden from their
shoulders; their hands were set free
from the basket. |
| 7 <i>Thou calledst in trouble, and I
delivered thee; I answered thee in the
secret place of thunder: I proved thee
at the waters of Meribah. Selah.</i> | In your distress you called and I
rescued you, I answered you out of a
thundercloud; I tested you at the waters
of Meribah. |
| 8 <i>Hear, O my people, and I will testify
unto thee: O Israel, if thou wilt
hearken unto me;</i> | Hear me, my people. I will warn you
— if you would only listen to me,
Israel! |
| 9 <i>There shall no strange god be in thee;
neither shalt thou worship any
strange god.</i> | You shall have no foreign god among
you; you shall not worship any god
other than me. |

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| <p>10 <i>I am the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt: open thy mouth wide, and I will fill it.</i></p> <p>11 <i>But my people would not hearken to my voice; and Israel would none of me.</i></p> <p>12 <i>So I gave them up unto their own hearts' lust: and they walked in their own counsels.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Oh that my people had hearkened unto me, and Israel had walked in my ways!</i></p> <p>14 <i>I should soon have subdued their enemies, and turned my hand against their adversaries.</i></p> <p>15 <i>The haters of the LORD should have submitted themselves unto him: but their time should have endured for ever.</i></p> <p>16 <i>He should have fed them also with the finest of the wheat: and with honey out of the rock should I have satisfied thee.</i></p> | <p>I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You up out of Egypt. Open wide Your mouth and I will fill it.</p> <p>But my people would not listen to me; Israel would not submit to me.</p> <p>So I gave them over to their stubborn hearts to follow their own devices.</p> <p>If my people would only listen to me, if Israel would only follow my ways,</p> <p>how quickly I would subdue their enemies and turn my hand against their foes!</p> <p>Those who hate the LORD would cringe before Him. Their punishment would last forever.</p> <p>But You would be fed with the finest of wheat; with honey from the rock I would satisfy You."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 31:7; Ps 66:1; Ps 100:1-2
v5 — Ps 114:1; Jer 5:15; Deut 28:49; 1 Cor 14:21-22
v6 — Isa 9:4; Isa 10:27; Ex 6:6; Matt 11:29
v7 — Ex 19:19; Num 20:13; Ex 2:23; Ps 50:15; Ps 91:14-15
v8 — Ps 50:7; Ex 15:26; John 3:11; Isa 1:19; John 3:32-33
v9 — Isa 43:12; Deut 32:12; 1 Cor 8:5-6
v10 — John 15:7; Ex 20:2; Ps 107:9; John 7:37; Rev 21:6
v11 — Jer 7:23-24; Deut 32:18; Ex 32:1; Jer 2:11-13; Prov 1:30
v12 — Jer 7:24; Rom 1:24; Isa 30:1; Acts 7:42; 2 Thess 2:9-11
v13 — Isa 48:18; Deut 5:29; Deut 10:12-13; Luke 19:41-42; Matt 23:37

v14 — Judg 2:20-23; Amos 1:8; Josh 23:13
v16 — Deut 32:13-14; Ps 147:14; 1 Sam 14:25-26; Joel 2:24; Judg 14:18

Psalm 82

God stands in the divine assembly and rebukes the unjust rulers who show partiality to the wicked and fail to defend the poor and fatherless. He declares that though they are called gods, they will die like men, and He calls on God to rise up and judge the whole earth.

1	<i>God standeth in the congregation of the mighty; he judgeth among the gods.</i>	God presides in the great assembly; He renders judgment among the gods:
2	<i>How long will ye judge unjustly, and accept the persons of the wicked? Selah.</i>	"How long will you defend the unjust and show partiality to the wicked?
3	<i>Defend the poor and fatherless: do justice to the afflicted and needy.</i>	Defend the weak and the fatherless; uphold the cause of the poor and the oppressed.
4	<i>Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked.</i>	Rescue the weak and the needy; deliver them from the hand of the wicked.
5	<i>They know not, neither will they understand; they walk on in darkness: all the foundations of the earth are out of course.</i>	The 'gods' know nothing, they understand nothing. They walk about in darkness; all the foundations of the earth are shaken.
6	<i>I have said, Ye are gods; and all of you are children of the most High.</i>	I said, 'You are gods; You are all sons of the Most High.'
7	<i>But ye shall die like men, and fall like one of the princes.</i>	But You shall die like men, and fall like one of the princes.
8	<i>Arise, O God, judge the earth: for thou shalt inherit all nations.</i>	Rise up, O God, judge the earth, for all the nations are your inheritance.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — John 10:35; 2 Chr 19:6-7; Ps 82:6-7; Isa 3:13; Ps 58:11
v2 — Deut 1:17; Prov 18:5

v3 — Jas 1:27; Ps 10:18; Jer 22:3; Deut 10:18; Jer 5:28

v4 — Prov 24:11-12; Job 5:15-16; Job 29:12; Ps 72:12-14; Ps 140:12

v5 — Ps 11:3; Rom 1:28; Prov 2:13; Mic 3:1; Prov 1:29

v6 — John 10:34-36; Ps 82:1

v7 — Ezek 31:14; Job 21:32; Ps 49:12

v8 — Rev 11:15; Ps 2:8; Ps 96:13; Ps 22:28; Ps 102:13

Psalm 83

The psalmist urgently pleads with God not to remain silent as a coalition of nations conspires to destroy Israel and wipe out its name. He calls on God to do to these enemies what He did to Midian, Sisera, and Jabin, so that all may know that JEHOVAH alone is the Most High over all the earth.

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| 1 | <i>Keep not thou silence, O God: hold not thy peace, and be not still, O God.</i> | O God, do not remain silent; do not turn a deaf ear, do not stand aloof, O God. |
| 2 | <i>For, lo, thine enemies make a tumult: and they that hate thee have lifted up the head.</i> | See how Your enemies growl, how Your foes rear their heads. |
| 3 | <i>They have taken crafty counsel against thy people, and consulted against thy hidden ones.</i> | With cunning they conspire against Your people; they plot against those You cherish. |
| 4 | <i>They have said, Come, and let us cut them off from being a nation; that the name of Israel may be no more in remembrance.</i> | "Come," they say, "let us destroy them as a nation, so that Israel's name is remembered no more." |
| 5 | <i>For they have consulted together with one consent: they are confederate against thee:</i> | With one mind they plot together; they form an alliance against You — |
| 6 | <i>The tabernacles of Edom, and the Ishmaelites; of Moab, and the Hagarenes;</i> | the tents of Edom and the Ishmaelites, of Moab and the Hagrites, |
| 7 | <i>Gebal, and Ammon, and Amalek; the Philistines with the inhabitants of Tyre;</i> | Byblos, Ammon and Amalek, Philistia, with the people of Tyre. |

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| 8 <i>Assur also is joined with them: they have holpen the children of Lot. Selah.</i> | Even Assyria has joined them to reinforce Lot's descendants. |
| 9 <i>Do unto them as unto the Midianites; as to Sisera, as to Jabin, at the brook of Kison:</i> | Do to them as you did to Midian, as you did to Sisera and Jabin at the river Kishon, |
| 10 <i>Which perished at Endor: they became as dung for the earth.</i> | who perished at Endor and became like dung on the ground. |
| 11 <i>Make their nobles like Oreb, and like Zeeb: yea, all their princes as Zebah, and as Zalmunna:</i> | Make their nobles like Oreb and Zeeb, all their princes like Zebah and Zalmunna, |
| 12 <i>Who said, Let us take to ourselves the houses of God in possession.</i> | who said, "Let us take possession of the pasturelands of God." |
| 13 <i>O my God, make them like a wheel; as the stubble before the wind.</i> | Make them like tumbleweed, my God, like chaff before the wind. |
| 14 <i>As the fire burneth a wood, and as the flame setteth the mountains on fire;</i> | As fire consumes the forest or a flame sets the mountains ablaze, |
| 15 <i>So persecute them with thy tempest, and make them afraid with thy storm.</i> | so pursue them with your tempest and terrify them with your storm. |
| 16 <i>Fill their faces with shame; that they may seek thy name, O LORD.</i> | Cover their faces with shame, LORD, so that they will seek Your name. |
| 17 <i>Let them be confounded and troubled for ever; yea, let them be put to shame, and perish:</i> | May they ever be ashamed and dismayed; may they perish in disgrace. |
| 18 <i>That men may know that thou, whose name alone is JEHOVAH, art the most high over all the earth.</i> | That men may know that You, whose name alone is JEHOVAH, are the Most High over all the earth. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 28:1; Ps 35:22

v2 — Ps 81:15

v3 — Ps 64:2; Ps 27:5; Ps 31:20; Isa 7:6-7

v4 — Jer 48:2; Jer 11:19; Ps 74:8; Esth 3:6-9; Acts 9:1-2

v5 — Ps 2:2

v7 — Josh 13:5

v8 — Deut 2:9

v11 — Judg 7:25

v13 — Ps 35:5; Job 21:18

v14 — Deut 32:22

v17 — Ps 35:4

v18 — Ex 6:3; Ps 59:13; Jer 16:21; Ezek 38:23; 2 Kgs 19:19

Psalm 84

The psalmist expresses deep longing for the courts of the LORD, declaring that even a single day in God's house is better than a thousand elsewhere. He pronounces blessings on those whose strength is in the LORD and who set their hearts on pilgrimage to Zion.

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| 1 | <i>How amiable are thy tabernacles, O LORD of hosts!</i> | How lovely are Your tabernacles, O LORD of hosts! |
| 2 | <i>My soul longeth, yea, even fainteth for the courts of the LORD: my heart and my flesh crieth out for the living God.</i> | My soul yearns, even faints, for the courts of the LORD; my heart and my flesh cry out for the living God. |
| 3 | <i>Yea, the sparrow hath found an house, and the swallow a nest for herself, where she may lay her young, even thine altars, O LORD of hosts, my King, and my God.</i> | Yes, the sparrow has found a house, and the swallow a nest for herself where she may lay her young — even Your altars, O LORD of hosts, my King and my God. |
| 4 | <i>Blessed are they that dwell in thy house: they will be still praising thee. Selah.</i> | Blessed are those who dwell in Your house; they are ever praising You. |
| 5 | <i>Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them.</i> | Blessed are those whose strength is in You, whose hearts are set on pilgrimage. |
| 6 | <i>Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well; the rain also filleth the pools.</i> | As they pass through the Valley of Baka, they make it a place of springs; the autumn rains also cover it with pools. |
| 7 | <i>They go from strength to strength, every one of them in Zion appeareth before God.</i> | They go from strength to strength, till each appears before God in Zion. |

8	<i>O LORD God of hosts, hear my prayer: give ear, O God of Jacob. Selah.</i>	O LORD God of hosts, hear my prayer; give ear, O God of Jacob. Selah.
9	<i>Behold, O God our shield, and look upon the face of thine anointed.</i>	Look, O God our shield, and look on the face of Your anointed.
10	<i>For a day in thy courts is better than a thousand. I had rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God, than to dwell in the tents of wickedness.</i>	Better is one day in Your courts than a thousand elsewhere; I would rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God than dwell in the tents of the wicked.
11	<i>For the LORD God is a sun and shield: the LORD will give grace and glory: no good thing will he withhold from them that walk uprightly.</i>	For the LORD God is a sun and shield; the LORD bestows favor and honor; no good thing does He withhold from those whose walk is blameless.
12	<i>O LORD of hosts, blessed is the man that trusteth in thee.</i>	O LORD of hosts, blessed is the man who trusts in you.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 27:4; Ps 43:3; Ps 122:1; Rev 21:22-23; Ps 36:8
- v2 — Isa 26:9; Ps 42:1-2; Ps 63:1-2; Ps 119:81; Ps 73:26
- v3 — Ps 90:1; Ps 91:1; Matt 8:20; Ps 43:4
- v4 — Ps 23:6; Ps 65:4; Ps 27:4; Isa 12:4-5; Ps 71:8
- v5 — Ps 28:7-8; 2 Cor 12:9; Zech 10:12; Phil 4:13; Ps 40:8
- v6 — 2 Cor 4:17; Rom 5:3-5; John 16:33; Joel 2:23; Rom 8:37
- v7 — Prov 4:18; 2 Cor 3:18; Isa 40:31; Job 17:9; 2 Pet 3:18
- v9 — Ps 2:2
- v10 — Ps 27:4; Ps 26:8-10; Ps 63:2; Phil 3:20; Ps 84:1-2
- v11 — Ps 34:9-10; Prov 2:7; Matt 6:33; Phil 4:19; Ps 85:12
- v12 — Ps 62:8; Jer 17:7-8; Isa 30:18; Isa 50:10; Ps 2:12

Psalm 85

The psalmist recalls how the LORD showed favor to His land and forgave His people, then pleads for revival and renewed mercy. He envisions a day when mercy and truth meet together, righteousness and peace kiss, and the LORD gives what is good so that the land yields its harvest.

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| 1 | <i>LORD, thou hast been favourable unto thy land: thou hast brought back the captivity of Jacob.</i> | You, LORD, showed favor to Your land; You restored the fortunes of Jacob. |
| 2 | <i>Thou hast forgiven the iniquity of thy people, thou hast covered all their sin. Selah.</i> | You forgave the iniquity of Your people and covered all their sins. |
| 3 | <i>Thou hast taken away all thy wrath: thou hast turned thyself from the fierceness of thine anger.</i> | You set aside all Your wrath and turned from Your fierce anger. |
| 4 | <i>Turn us, O God of our salvation, and cause thine anger toward us to cease.</i> | Restore us again, God our Savior, and put away Your displeasure toward us. |
| 5 | <i>Wilt thou be angry with us for ever? wilt thou draw out thine anger to all generations?</i> | Will You be angry with us forever? Will You prolong Your anger through all generations? |
| 6 | <i>Wilt thou not revive us again: that thy people may rejoice in thee?</i> | Will You not revive us again, that Your people may rejoice in You? |
| 7 | <i>Shew us thy mercy, O LORD, and grant us thy salvation.</i> | Show us Your mercy, LORD, and grant us Your salvation. |
| 8 | <i>I will hear what God the LORD will speak: for he will speak peace unto his people, and to his saints: but let them not turn again to folly.</i> | I will hear what God the LORD will speak, for He will speak peace to His people and to His saints; but let them not turn again to folly. |
| 9 | <i>Surely his salvation is nigh them that fear him; that glory may dwell in our land.</i> | Surely His salvation is near those who fear Him, that glory may dwell in our land. |
| 10 | <i>Mercy and truth are met together; righteousness and peace have kissed each other.</i> | Mercy and truth have met together; righteousness and peace have kissed each other. |
| 11 | <i>Truth shall spring out of the earth; and righteousness shall look down from heaven.</i> | Faithfulness springs forth from the earth, and righteousness looks down from heaven. |
| 12 | <i>Yea, the LORD shall give that which is good; and our land shall yield her increase.</i> | The LORD will indeed give what is good, and our land will yield its harvest. |

- 13 *Righteousness shall go before him; and shall set us in the way of his steps.* Righteousness goes before Him and prepares the way for His steps.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 30:18; Ps 14:7; Ezek 39:25; Ps 77:7; Ps 42:1
- v2 — Mic 7:18; Col 2:13; Ps 32:1; Num 14:19; Acts 13:39
- v3 — Ps 106:23; Deut 13:17
- v4 — Lam 5:21; Ps 80:3; Ps 80:7; Mic 7:7
- v6 — Hab 3:2; Ps 80:18; Isa 57:15; Ps 90:14; Hos 6:2
- v7 — Ps 91:16; Ps 50:23
- v8 — Ps 29:11; Rev 3:19; John 14:27; Zech 9:10; Heb 10:26-29
- v9 — Isa 46:13; Zech 2:5; John 7:17; Zech 2:8; Luke 2:32
- v10 — Prov 3:3; Ps 89:14; Isa 32:16-18; John 1:17; Ps 100:5
- v11 — John 14:6; Isa 45:8; 1 John 5:20-21; Matt 17:5; Isa 42:21
- v12 — Jas 1:17; Ps 84:11; Ps 67:6; Lev 26:4; 1 Cor 1:30
- v13 — Ps 89:14; John 13:34

Psalm 86

David pleads for mercy as a poor and needy servant, declaring that among the gods there is none like the LORD who is good, ready to forgive, and plenteous in mercy. He asks God for an undivided heart, protection from arrogant foes, and a sign of His goodness.

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| 1 | <i>Bow down thine ear, O LORD, hear me: for I am poor and needy.</i> | Hear me, LORD, and answer me, for I am poor and needy. |
| 2 | <i>Preserve my soul; for I am holy: O thou my God, save thy servant that trusteth in thee.</i> | Guard my life, for I am faithful to You; save Your servant who trusts in You. You are my God; |
| 3 | <i>Be merciful unto me, O Lord: for I cry unto thee daily.</i> | have mercy on me, Lord, for I call to You all day long. |
| 4 | <i>Rejoice the soul of thy servant: for unto thee, O Lord, do I lift up my soul.</i> | Bring joy to Your servant, Lord, for I put my trust in You. |
| 5 | <i>For thou, Lord, art good, and ready to forgive; and plenteous in mercy unto all them that call upon thee.</i> | For You, Lord, are good, and ready to forgive, and plenteous in mercy to all who call on You. |

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| 6 <i>Give ear, O LORD, unto my prayer;
and attend to the voice of my
supplications.</i> | Hear my prayer, LORD; listen to my
cry for mercy. |
| 7 <i>In the day of my trouble I will call
upon thee: for thou wilt answer me.</i> | When I am in distress, I call to You,
because You answer me. |
| 8 <i>Among the gods there is none like
unto thee, O Lord; neither are there
any works like unto thy works.</i> | Among the gods there is none like
You, Lord; no deeds can compare with
Yours. |
| 9 <i>All nations whom thou hast made
shall come and worship before thee, O
Lord; and shall glorify thy name.</i> | All the nations you have made will
come and worship before You, Lord;
they will bring glory to Your name. |
| 10 <i>For thou art great, and doest
wondrous things: thou art God alone.</i> | For You are great and do marvelous
deeds; You alone are God. |
| 11 <i>Teach me thy way, O LORD; I will
walk in thy truth: unite my heart to
fear thy name.</i> | Teach me Your way, LORD, that I
may rely on Your faithfulness; give me
an undivided heart, that I may fear
Your name. |
| 12 <i>I will praise thee, O Lord my God,
with all my heart: and I will glorify
thy name for evermore.</i> | I will praise You, Lord my God, with
all my heart; I will glorify Your name
forever. |
| 13 <i>For great is thy mercy toward me:
and thou hast delivered my soul from
the lowest hell.</i> | For great is Your mercy toward me;
and You have delivered my soul from
the lowest hell. |
| 14 <i>O God, the proud are risen against
me, and the assemblies of violent men
have sought after my soul; and have
not set thee before them.</i> | Arrogant foes are attacking me, O
God; ruthless people are trying to kill
me — they have no regard for You. |
| 15 <i>But thou, O Lord, art a God full of
compassion, and gracious,
longsuffering, and plenteous in mercy
and truth.</i> | But You, O Lord, are a God full of
compassion, and gracious,
longsuffering, and plenteous in mercy
and truth. |

- 16

O turn unto me, and have mercy upon me; give thy strength unto thy servant, and save the son of thine handmaid.

Turn to me and have mercy on me; show Your strength in behalf of Your servant; save me, the son of Your servant.
- 17

Shew me a token for good; that they which hate me may see it, and be ashamed: because thou, LORD, hast holpen me, and comforted me.

Give me a sign of Your goodness, that my enemies may see it and be put to shame, for You, LORD, have helped me and comforted me.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 31:2; Ps 40:17; Dan 9:18; Matt 5:3; Ps 34:6
- v5 — Ps 145:8-9; Joel 2:13; Ex 34:6; Neh 9:17; Ps 103:8
- v7 — Jonah 2:2; Ps 34:4-6; Ps 50:15; Ps 17:6; Heb 5:7
- v8 — Ex 15:11; Deut 3:24; Ps 89:6; Dan 3:29; Ps 89:8
- v9 — Rev 15:4; Isa 66:23; Ps 66:4; Rev 11:15; Isa 2:2-4
- v10 — Isa 37:16; Mark 12:29; Ps 72:18; 1 Cor 8:4; Deut 32:39
- v11 — Jer 32:38-39; Ps 25:4-5; Ps 5:8; Ps 119:33; Ps 143:8-10
- v12 — Deut 6:5; Ps 146:1-2; Rom 15:6; Rev 19:5-6; 1 Cor 10:31
- v13 — Ps 103:8-12; Luke 1:58; Ps 56:13; Job 33:28; Ps 116:8
- v15 — Eph 2:4-7; Ps 130:7; Eph 1:7; Ps 103:8; Ps 86:5
- v16 — Eph 6:10; Phil 4:13; Isa 40:29-31; Ps 25:16; Ps 116:16
- v17 — Ps 41:10-11; Judg 6:17; Ps 71:20-21; Mic 7:8-10; Ps 71:9-13

Psalm 87

The psalmist celebrates Zion as God's beloved city, founded on the holy mountains and loved above all the dwellings of Jacob. God Himself registers the peoples of the nations as born in Zion, declaring that all the fountains of life spring from her.

- 1

His foundation is in the holy mountains.

He has founded his city on the holy mountain.
- 2

The LORD loveth the gates of Zion more than all the dwellings of Jacob.

The LORD loves the gates of Zion more than all the other dwellings of Jacob.
- 3

Glorious things are spoken of thee, O city of God. Selah.

Glorious things are said of You, city of God:

4	<i>I will make mention of Rahab and Babylon to them that know me: behold Philistia, and Tyre, with Ethiopia; this man was born there.</i>	"I will record Rahab and Babylon among those who acknowledge me — Philistia too, and Tyre, along with Cush — and will say, 'This one was born in Zion.' "
5	<i>And of Zion it shall be said, This and that man was born in her: and the highest himself shall establish her.</i>	Indeed, of Zion it will be said, "This one and that one were born in her, and the Most High Himself will establish her."
6	<i>The LORD shall count, when he writeth up the people, that this man was born there. Selah.</i>	The LORD will write in the register of the peoples: "This one was born in Zion."
7	<i>As well the singers as the players on instruments shall be there: all my springs are in thee.</i>	As they make music they will sing, "All my fountains are in You."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 28:16; Isa 56:7; Eph 2:20-22; Isa 2:2-3; Ps 48:1-2
- v2 — Ps 132:13-14; Ps 78:67-69; Deut 12:5
- v3 — Ezek 37:27-28; Ezek 36:11-38
- v4 — Ps 45:12
- v5 — Rom 8:31; 1 Pet 1:23-24; Gal 3:26-28; John 1:12-14; Ezek 48:35
- v6 — Isa 4:3; Luke 10:20; Rev 20:15; Ezek 13:9
- v7 — Ps 36:9; John 1:16; Isa 12:3; Rev 22:17; John 4:14

Psalm 88

The psalmist cries out from the brink of death, overwhelmed by God's wrath, abandoned by friends, and surrounded by darkness with no relief in sight. This is the darkest psalm in the Psalter — it ends without resolution, with darkness as the psalmist's only companion.

1	<i>O LORD God of my salvation, I have cried day and night before thee:</i>	LORD, You are the God Who saves me; day and night I cry out to You.
2	<i>Let my prayer come before thee: incline thine ear unto my cry;</i>	May my prayer come before You; turn Your ear to my cry.

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| 3 | <i>For my soul is full of troubles: and my life draweth nigh unto the grave.</i> | I am overwhelmed with troubles and my life draws near to death. |
| 4 | <i>I am counted with them that go down into the pit: I am as a man that hath no strength:</i> | I am counted among those who go down to the pit; I am like one without strength. |
| 5 | <i>Free among the dead, like the slain that lie in the grave, whom thou rememberest no more: and they are cut off from thy hand.</i> | I am set apart with the dead, like the slain who lie in the grave, whom You remember no more, who are cut off from Your care. |
| 6 | <i>Thou hast laid me in the lowest pit, in darkness, in the deeps.</i> | You have put me in the lowest pit, in the darkest depths. |
| 7 | <i>Thy wrath lieth hard upon me, and thou hast afflicted me with all thy waves. Selah.</i> | Your wrath lies heavily on me; You have overwhelmed me with all Your waves. |
| 8 | <i>Thou hast put away mine acquaintance far from me; thou hast made me an abomination unto them: I am shut up, and I cannot come forth.</i> | You have taken from me my closest friends and have made me repulsive to them. I am confined and cannot escape; |
| 9 | <i>Mine eye mourneth by reason of affliction: LORD, I have called daily upon thee, I have stretched out my hands unto thee.</i> | my eyes are dim with grief. I call to You, LORD, every day; I spread out my hands to You. |
| 10 | <i>Wilt thou shew wonders to the dead? shall the dead arise and praise thee? Selah.</i> | Do You show Your wonders to the dead? Do their spirits rise up and praise You? |
| 11 | <i>Shall thy lovingkindness be declared in the grave? or thy faithfulness in destruction?</i> | Shall Your lovingkindness be declared in the grave, or Your faithfulness in destruction? |
| 12 | <i>Shall thy wonders be known in the dark? and thy righteousness in the land of forgetfulness?</i> | Are Your wonders known in the place of darkness, or Your righteous deeds in the land of oblivion? |
| 13 | <i>But unto thee have I cried, O LORD; and in the morning shall my prayer prevent thee.</i> | But I cry to You for help, LORD; in the morning my prayer comes before You. |

14	<i>LORD, why castest thou off my soul? why hidest thou thy face from me?</i>	Why, LORD, do You reject me and hide Your face from me?
15	<i>I am afflicted and ready to die from my youth up: while I suffer thy terrors I am distracted.</i>	From my youth I have suffered and been close to death; I have borne Your terrors and am in despair.
16	<i>Thy fierce wrath goeth over me; thy terrors have cut me off.</i>	Your wrath has swept over me; Your terrors have destroyed me.
17	<i>They came round about me daily like water; they compassed me about together.</i>	All day long they surround me like a flood; they have completely engulfed me.
18	<i>Lover and friend hast thou put far from me, and mine acquaintance into darkness.</i>	You have taken from me friend and neighbor — darkness is my closest friend.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 22:2; Isa 12:2; Luke 18:7; Ps 86:3
- v2 — Ps 31:2
- v3 — Ps 107:18
- v4 — Ps 28:1; 2 Cor 1:9
- v5 — Isa 53:8
- v9 — Job 11:13; Ps 38:10; Ps 86:3
- v10 — Ps 6:5; Isa 26:19; Ps 30:9
- v12 — Eccl 9:5
- v13 — Ps 5:3; Mark 1:35; Ps 30:2; Ps 119:147-148
- v14 — Job 13:24; Ps 13:1
- v15 — Job 6:4; Luke 22:44
- v18 — Ps 88:8; Ps 38:11

Psalm 89

Ethan celebrates God's covenant with David, praising His faithfulness and His sworn oath to establish David's throne forever. But the psalm turns to anguish as the psalmist confronts the apparent ruin of that covenant — the king is cast down, the crown defiled — and he cries out, asking how long the LORD will hide Himself.

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| 1 <i>I will sing of the mercies of the LORD for ever: with my mouth will I make known thy faithfulness to all generations.</i> | I will sing of the mercies of the LORD forever; with my mouth I will make known Your faithfulness to all generations. |
| 2 <i>For I have said, Mercy shall be built up for ever: thy faithfulness shalt thou establish in the very heavens.</i> | For I have said, Mercy shall be built up forever; Your faithfulness You shall establish in the very heavens. |
| 3 <i>I have made a covenant with my chosen, I have sworn unto David my servant,</i> | You said, "I have made a covenant with my chosen one, I have sworn to David my servant, |
| 4 <i>Thy seed will I establish for ever, and build up thy throne to all generations. Selah.</i> | 'I will establish your line forever and make your throne firm through all generations.' " |
| 5 <i>And the heavens shall praise thy wonders, O LORD: thy faithfulness also in the congregation of the saints.</i> | The heavens praise Your wonders, LORD, Your faithfulness too, in the assembly of the holy ones. |
| 6 <i>For who in the heaven can be compared unto the LORD? who among the sons of the mighty can be likened unto the LORD?</i> | For who in the skies above can compare with the LORD? Who is like the LORD among the heavenly beings? |
| 7 <i>God is greatly to be feared in the assembly of the saints, and to be had in reverence of all them that are about him.</i> | In the council of the holy ones God is greatly feared; He is more awesome than all who surround Him. |
| 8 <i>O LORD God of hosts, who is a strong LORD like unto thee? or to thy faithfulness round about thee?</i> | O LORD God of hosts, who is a strong LORD like You? Or to Your faithfulness round about You? |
| 9 <i>Thou rulest the raging of the sea: when the waves thereof arise, thou stillest them.</i> | You rule over the surging sea; when its waves mount up, You still them. |
| 10 <i>Thou hast broken Rahab in pieces, as one that is slain; thou hast scattered thine enemies with thy strong arm.</i> | You crushed Rahab like one of the slain; with Your strong arm You scattered Your enemies. |

- 11 *The heavens are thine, the earth also is thine: as for the world and the fulness thereof, thou hast founded them.* The heavens are Yours, and Yours also the earth; You founded the world and all that is in it.
- 12 *The north and the south thou hast created them: Tabor and Hermon shall rejoice in thy name.* You created the north and the south; Tabor and Hermon sing for joy at Your name.
- 13 *Thou hast a mighty arm: strong is thy hand, and high is thy right hand.* Your arm is endowed with power; Your hand is strong, Your right hand exalted.
- 14 *Justice and judgment are the habitation of thy throne: mercy and truth shall go before thy face.* Justice and judgment are the habitation of Your throne; mercy and truth shall go before Your face.
- 15 *Blessed is the people that know the joyful sound: they shall walk, O LORD, in the light of thy countenance.* Blessed are the people who know the joyful sound; they shall walk, O LORD, in the light of Your countenance.
- 16 *In thy name shall they rejoice all the day: and in thy righteousness shall they be exalted.* They rejoice in Your name all day long; they celebrate Your righteousness.
- 17 *For thou art the glory of their strength: and in thy favour our horn shall be exalted.* For You are their glory and strength, and by Your favor You exalt our horn.
- 18 *For the LORD is our defence; and the Holy One of Israel is our king.* Indeed, our shield belongs to the LORD, our king to the Holy One of Israel.
- 19 *Then thou spakest in vision to thy holy one, and saidst, I have laid help upon one that is mighty; I have exalted one chosen out of the people.* Then You spoke in vision to Your holy one, and said, "I have laid help on one who is mighty; I have exalted one chosen out of the people.
- 20 *I have found David my servant; with my holy oil have I anointed him:* I have found David my servant; with my sacred oil I have anointed him.

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| 21 <i>With whom my hand shall be established: mine arm also shall strengthen him.</i> | My hand will sustain him; surely my arm will strengthen him. |
| 22 <i>The enemy shall not exact upon him; nor the son of wickedness afflict him.</i> | The enemy will not get the better of him; the wicked will not oppress him. |
| 23 <i>And I will beat down his foes before his face, and plague them that hate him.</i> | I will crush his foes before him and strike down his adversaries. |
| 24 <i>But my faithfulness and my mercy shall be with him: and in my name shall his horn be exalted.</i> | But my faithfulness and my mercy shall be with him, and in my name shall his horn be exalted. |
| 25 <i>I will set his hand also in the sea, and his right hand in the rivers.</i> | I will set his hand over the sea, his right hand over the rivers. |
| 26 <i>He shall cry unto me, Thou art my father, my God, and the rock of my salvation.</i> | He will call out to me, 'You are my Father, my God, the Rock my Savior.' |
| 27 <i>Also I will make him my firstborn, higher than the kings of the earth.</i> | I will appoint him to be my firstborn, the most exalted of the kings of the earth. |
| 28 <i>My mercy will I keep for him for evermore, and my covenant shall stand fast with him.</i> | My mercy I will keep for him forever, and my covenant shall stand fast with him. |
| 29 <i>His seed also will I make to endure for ever, and his throne as the days of heaven.</i> | I will establish his line forever, his throne as long as the heavens endure. |
| 30 <i>If his children forsake my law, and walk not in my judgments;</i> | If his sons forsake my law and do not follow my statutes, |
| 31 <i>If they break my statutes, and keep not my commandments;</i> | if they violate my decrees and fail to keep my commands, |
| 32 <i>Then will I visit their transgression with the rod, and their iniquity with stripes.</i> | I will punish their sin with the rod, their iniquity with flogging; |

- 33 *Nevertheless my lovingkindness will I not utterly take from him, nor suffer my faithfulness to fail.* Nevertheless my lovingkindness I will not utterly take from him, nor allow my faithfulness to fail.
- 34 *My covenant will I not break, nor alter the thing that is gone out of my lips.* I will not violate my covenant or alter what my lips have uttered.
- 35 *Once have I sworn by my holiness that I will not lie unto David.* Once for all, I have sworn by my holiness — and I will not lie to David —
- 36 *His seed shall endure for ever, and his throne as the sun before me.* that his line will continue forever and his throne endure before me like the sun;
- 37 *It shall be established for ever as the moon, and as a faithful witness in heaven. Selah.* it will be established forever like the moon, the faithful witness in the sky."
- 38 *But thou hast cast off and abhorred, thou hast been wroth with thine anointed.* But you have cast off and abhorred; you have been angry with your anointed.
- 39 *Thou hast made void the covenant of thy servant: thou hast profaned his crown by casting it to the ground.* You have renounced the covenant with your servant and have defiled his crown in the dust.
- 40 *Thou hast broken down all his hedges; thou hast brought his strong holds to ruin.* You have broken through all his walls and reduced his strongholds to ruins.
- 41 *All that pass by the way spoil him: he is a reproach to his neighbours.* All who pass by have plundered him; he has become the scorn of his neighbors.
- 42 *Thou hast set up the right hand of his adversaries; thou hast made all his enemies to rejoice.* You have exalted the right hand of his foes; you have made all his enemies rejoice.
- 43 *Thou hast also turned the edge of his sword, and hast not made him to stand in the battle.* Indeed, you have turned back the edge of his sword and have not supported him in battle.

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| <p>44 <i>Thou hast made his glory to cease, and cast his throne down to the ground.</i></p> <p>45 <i>The days of his youth hast thou shortened: thou hast covered him with shame. Selah.</i></p> <p>46 <i>How long, LORD? wilt thou hide thyself for ever? shall thy wrath burn like fire?</i></p> <p>47 <i>Remember how short my time is: wherefore hast thou made all men in vain?</i></p> <p>48 <i>What man is he that liveth, and shall not see death? shall he deliver his soul from the hand of the grave? Selah.</i></p> <p>49 <i>Lord, where are thy former lovingkindnesses, which thou swarest unto David in thy truth?</i></p> <p>50 <i>Remember, Lord, the reproach of thy servants; how I do bear in my bosom the reproach of all the mighty people;</i></p> <p>51 <i>Wherewith thine enemies have reproached, O LORD; wherewith they have reproached the footsteps of thine anointed.</i></p> <p>52 <i>Blessed be the LORD for evermore. Amen, and Amen.</i></p> | <p>You have put an end to his splendor and cast his throne to the ground.</p> <p>You have cut short the days of his youth; you have covered him with a mantle of shame.</p> <p>How long, LORD? Will You hide Yourself forever? How long will Your wrath burn like fire?</p> <p>Remember how short my time is; why have You made all men in vain?</p> <p>Who can live and not see death, or who can escape the power of the grave?</p> <p>Lord, where are your former lovingkindnesses, which you swore to David in your truth?</p> <p>Remember, Lord, how your servant has been mocked, how I bear in my heart the taunts of all the nations, with which Your enemies have reproached, O LORD; with which they have reproached the footsteps of Your anointed.</p> <p>Praise be to the LORD forever! Amen and Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 101:1; Ps 89:8; Ps 119:90; Lam 3:23; Ps 89:33

v6 — Ps 86:8; Ps 71:19; Ps 113:5; Ps 29:1; Jer 10:6

v9 — Ps 65:7; Ps 107:25-29; Mark 4:41; Matt 8:24-27; Mark 4:39

v11 — 1 Chr 29:11; Gen 1:1; Ps 115:16; Ps 24:1-2; 1 Cor 10:26
v14 — Ps 97:2; Prov 16:12; Ps 45:6-7; Ps 145:17; Ps 85:13
v15 — Ps 44:3; Job 29:3; Ps 4:6; Ps 100:1; Isa 2:5
v20 — 1 Sam 16:12-13; Isa 61:1-3; 1 Sam 16:1; John 3:34; Acts 13:22
v27 — Col 1:18; Col 1:15; Rev 19:16; Rom 8:29; Ps 2:7
v33 — Isa 54:8-10; Lam 3:31-32; 2 Sam 7:15; Jer 33:20-26; Heb 6:18
v34 — Num 23:19; Matt 24:35; Jas 1:17; Rom 11:29; Mal 3:6
v35 — Ps 132:11; Heb 6:13; Titus 1:2; Heb 6:17; Amos 4:2
v48 — Ps 49:15; Eccl 9:5; Heb 11:5; Eccl 12:7; Ps 49:7-9

Psalm 90

Moses meditates on God's eternity against the brevity of human life, noting that a thousand years are like a day in God's sight and man's years are but seventy or eighty. He prays that God would teach His people to number their days, satisfy them with mercy, and establish the work of their hands.

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| 1 <i>LORD, thou hast been our dwelling place in all generations.</i> | Lord, you have been our dwelling place throughout all generations. |
| 2 <i>Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever thou hadst formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God.</i> | Before the mountains were born or you brought forth the whole world, from everlasting to everlasting you are God. |
| 3 <i>Thou turnest man to destruction; and sayest, Return, ye children of men.</i> | You turn man to destruction, and say, "Return, you children of men." |
| 4 <i>For a thousand years in thy sight are but as yesterday when it is past, and as a watch in the night.</i> | A thousand years in your sight are like a day that has just gone by, or like a watch in the night. |
| 5 <i>Thou carriest them away as with a flood; they are as a sleep: in the morning they are like grass which groweth up.</i> | Yet you sweep people away in the sleep of death — they are like the new grass of the morning: |
| 6 <i>In the morning it flourisheth, and groweth up; in the evening it is cut down, and withereth.</i> | In the morning it springs up new, but by evening it is dry and withered. |
| 7 <i>For we are consumed by thine anger, and by thy wrath are we troubled.</i> | We are consumed by your anger and terrified by your indignation. |

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| 8 <i>Thou hast set our iniquities before thee, our secret sins in the light of thy countenance.</i> | You have set our iniquities before you, our secret sins in the light of your countenance. |
| 9 <i>For all our days are passed away in thy wrath: we spend our years as a tale that is told.</i> | All our days pass away under your wrath; we finish our years with a moan. |
| 10 <i>The days of our years are threescore years and ten; and if by reason of strength they be fourscore years, yet is their strength labour and sorrow; for it is soon cut off, and we fly away.</i> | Our days may come to seventy years, or eighty, if our strength endures; yet the best of them are but trouble and sorrow, for they quickly pass. We fly away. |
| 11 <i>Who knoweth the power of thine anger? even according to thy fear, so is thy wrath.</i> | If only we knew the power of your anger! Your wrath is as great as the fear that is your due. |
| 12 <i>So teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom.</i> | Teach us to number our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom. |
| 13 <i>Return, O LORD, how long? and let it repent thee concerning thy servants.</i> | Relent, LORD! How long will it be? Have compassion on Your servants. |
| 14 <i>O satisfy us early with thy mercy; that we may rejoice and be glad all our days.</i> | O satisfy us early with Your mercy, that we may rejoice and be glad all our days. |
| 15 <i>Make us glad according to the days wherein thou hast afflicted us, and the years wherein we have seen evil.</i> | Make us glad for as many days as You have afflicted us, for as many years as we have seen trouble. |
| 16 <i>Let thy work appear unto thy servants, and thy glory unto their children.</i> | May Your deeds be shown to Your servants, Your splendor to their children. |
| 17 <i>And let the beauty of the LORD our God be upon us: and establish thou the work of our hands upon us; yea, the work of our hands establish thou it.</i> | May the favor of the Lord our God rest on us; establish the work of our hands for us — yes, establish the work of our hands. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 33:27; 1 John 4:16; Ps 71:3; Ps 91:1; Ezek 11:16
- v2 — Heb 13:8; Gen 1:1; Ps 102:24-27; Ps 93:2; Rev 1:8
- v3 — Gen 3:19; Eccl 12:7
- v4 — 2 Pet 3:8; Ps 39:5; Matt 24:43; Luke 12:38
- v5 — Isa 40:6; Ps 73:20; 1 Pet 1:24; Ps 103:15-16; Job 22:16
- v8 — Jer 16:17; Eccl 12:14; Ps 19:12; Jer 23:24; Heb 4:12-13
- v10 — Jas 4:14; Ps 78:39; 2 Sam 19:35; Gen 47:9; Deut 34:7
- v12 — Eph 5:16-17; Ps 39:4; John 9:4; Deut 32:29; Prov 4:7
- v13 — Ps 106:45; Deut 32:36; Ps 135:14
- v14 — Ps 23:6; Ps 85:6; Ps 31:7; Ps 86:4; Ps 103:3-5
- v15 — Ps 30:5; Ps 126:5-6; Isa 40:1-2; John 16:20; Isa 12:1
- v17 — Prov 16:3; 1 Cor 3:7; Job 22:28; 2 Thess 2:16-3:1; Ps 118:25

Psalm 91

The psalmist declares that whoever dwells in the shelter of the Most High will be protected from pestilence, terror, and every danger, with angels guarding their way. God Himself speaks the closing promise: because the faithful one has set his love on the LORD, He will deliver, honor, and satisfy him with long life.

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| 1 | <i>He that dwelleth in the secret place of the most High shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty.</i> | Whoever dwells in the shelter of the Most High will rest in the shadow of the Almighty. |
| 2 | <i>I will say of the LORD, He is my refuge and my fortress: my God; in him will I trust.</i> | I will say of the LORD, "He is my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust." |
| 3 | <i>Surely he shall deliver thee from the snare of the fowler, and from the noisome pestilence.</i> | Surely He will save You from the fowler's snare and from the deadly pestilence. |
| 4 | <i>He shall cover thee with his feathers, and under his wings shalt thou trust: his truth shall be thy shield and buckler.</i> | He will cover You with His feathers, and under His wings You will find refuge; His faithfulness will be Your shield and rampart. |
| 5 | <i>Thou shalt not be afraid for the terror by night; nor for the arrow that flieth by day;</i> | You will not fear the terror of night, nor the arrow that flies by day, |

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| 6 | <i>Nor for the pestilence that walketh in darkness; nor for the destruction that wasteth at noonday.</i> | nor the pestilence that stalks in the darkness, nor the plague that destroys at midday. |
| 7 | <i>A thousand shall fall at thy side, and ten thousand at thy right hand; but it shall not come nigh thee.</i> | A thousand may fall at Your side, ten thousand at Your right hand. But It will not come near You. |
| 8 | <i>Only with thine eyes shalt thou behold and see the reward of the wicked.</i> | You will only observe with your eyes and see the punishment of the wicked. |
| 9 | <i>Because thou hast made the LORD, which is my refuge, even the most High, thy habitation;</i> | If You say, "The LORD is my refuge," and You make the Most High Your dwelling, |
| 10 | <i>There shall no evil befall thee, neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling.</i> | no harm will overtake You, no disaster will come near Your tent. |
| 11 | <i>For he shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee in all thy ways.</i> | For He will command His angels concerning You to guard You in all Your ways; |
| 12 | <i>They shall bear thee up in their hands, lest thou dash thy foot against a stone.</i> | they will lift You up in their hands, so that You will not strike Your foot against a stone. |
| 13 | <i>Thou shalt tread upon the lion and adder: the young lion and the dragon shalt thou trample under feet.</i> | You will tread on the lion and the cobra; you will trample the great lion and the serpent. |
| 14 | <i>Because he hath set his love upon me, therefore will I deliver him: I will set him on high, because he hath known my name.</i> | Because he has set his love on me, therefore I will deliver him; I will set him on high, because he has known my name. |
| 15 | <i>He shall call upon me, and I will answer him: I will be with him in trouble; I will deliver him, and honour him.</i> | He will call on me. I will answer him; I will be with him in trouble, I will deliver him and honor him. |
| 16 | <i>With long life will I satisfy him, and shew him my salvation.</i> | With long life I will satisfy him and show him my salvation." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 32:7; Ps 27:5; Ps 36:7; Ps 17:8; 1 John 4:15-16
- v2 — Ps 18:2; Isa 26:3-4; Prov 18:10; Isa 12:2; Ps 142:5
- v3 — Ps 124:7; Ps 141:9; Job 5:10-22; Prov 7:23; Prov 6:5
- v4 — Ps 61:4; Ps 57:1; Ps 17:8; Deut 32:11; Isa 43:1-2
- v5 — Isa 43:2; Job 5:19-27; Prov 3:23-25; Ps 3:5-6; Heb 13:6
- v9 — Ps 71:3; Ps 91:1-2; Ps 90:1; Ps 142:4-5; Ps 146:5-6
- v10 — Prov 12:21; Ps 121:7; Deut 7:15; Rom 8:25; Job 5:24
- v11 — Luke 4:10-11; Ps 34:7; Heb 1:14; Prov 3:6; Matt 4:6
- v13 — Luke 10:19; Mark 16:18; Dan 6:22; 1 Sam 17:37; Rom 16:20
- v14 — Ps 9:10; John 14:23; Jas 1:12; John 16:27; Rom 8:28
- v15 — Jer 33:3; Ps 50:15; Isa 65:24; Ps 138:7; John 12:26
- v16 — Prov 3:2; Prov 3:16; Ps 21:4; Ps 50:23; Isa 65:20-22

Psalm 92

The psalmist declares it good to praise the LORD with music, rejoicing in God's works and the downfall of the wicked. While evildoers spring up like grass only to be destroyed, the righteous flourish like palm trees and cedars, bearing fruit even in old age.

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| 1 | <i>It is a good thing to give thanks unto the LORD, and to sing praises unto thy name, O most High:</i> | It is good to praise the LORD and make music to Your name, O Most High, |
| 2 | <i>To shew forth thy lovingkindness in the morning, and thy faithfulness every night,</i> | to show forth Your lovingkindness in the morning, and Your faithfulness every night, |
| 3 | <i>Upon an instrument of ten strings, and upon the psaltery; upon the harp with a solemn sound.</i> | to the music of the ten-stringed lyre and the melody of the harp. |
| 4 | <i>For thou, LORD, hast made me glad through thy work: I will triumph in the works of thy hands.</i> | For You make me glad by Your deeds, LORD; I sing for joy at what Your hands have done. |
| 5 | <i>O LORD, how great are thy works! and thy thoughts are very deep.</i> | How great are Your works, LORD, how profound Your thoughts! |
| 6 | <i>A brutish man knoweth not; neither doth a fool understand this.</i> | Senseless people do not know, fools do not understand, |

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| <p>7 <i>When the wicked spring as the grass, and when all the workers of iniquity do flourish; it is that they shall be destroyed for ever:</i></p> <p>8 <i>But thou, LORD, art most high for evermore.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For, lo, thine enemies, O LORD, for, lo, thine enemies shall perish; all the workers of iniquity shall be scattered.</i></p> <p>10 <i>But my horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn: I shall be anointed with fresh oil.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Mine eye also shall see my desire on mine enemies, and mine ears shall hear my desire of the wicked that rise up against me.</i></p> <p>12 <i>The righteous shall flourish like the palm tree: he shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Those that be planted in the house of the LORD shall flourish in the courts of our God.</i></p> <p>14 <i>They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; they shall be fat and flourishing;</i></p> <p>15 <i>To shew that the LORD is upright: he is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him.</i></p> | <p>that though the wicked spring up like grass and all evildoers flourish, they will be destroyed forever.</p> <p>But You, LORD, are forever exalted.</p> <p>For surely Your enemies, LORD, surely Your enemies will perish; all evildoers will be scattered.</p> <p>But my horn You shall exalt like the horn of a unicorn; I shall be anointed with fresh oil.</p> <p>My eyes have seen the defeat of my adversaries; my ears have heard the rout of my wicked foes.</p> <p>The righteous will flourish like a palm tree, they will grow like a cedar of Lebanon;</p> <p>planted in the house of the LORD, they will flourish in the courts of our God.</p> <p>They will still bear fruit in old age, they will stay fresh and green, proclaiming, "The LORD is upright; He is my Rock, and there is no wickedness in Him."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 147:1; Ps 107:1; Eph 5:19; Ps 135:3; Ps 107:21-22
- v2 — Lam 3:22-23; Ps 89:1-2; John 1:17; Isa 63:7; Ps 42:8
- v4 — 2 Cor 2:14; Ps 8:6; Ps 126:3; Luke 1:47; Isa 65:13-14
- v5 — Rom 11:33-34; Isa 55:8-9; Ps 40:5; Ps 139:17; Ps 145:3-4

- v6 — Ps 94:8; Ps 73:22; 1 Cor 2:14; Prov 1:22; Ps 49:10
- v7 — Ps 37:38; Ps 73:18-20; Ps 37:35-36; Ps 37:1-2; Jer 12:1-2
- v10 — Ps 23:5; Ps 89:17; Ps 45:7; 2 Cor 1:21; Ps 75:10
- v11 — Ps 54:7; Ps 91:8; Ps 59:10; Ps 112:8; Ps 37:34
- v12 — Ps 1:3; Jer 17:8; Ps 52:8; Ps 104:16; Hos 14:5-6
- v13 — 2 Pet 3:18; Isa 61:3; Eph 3:17; Rom 6:5; Isa 60:21
- v14 — Isa 46:4; Ps 71:18; Jer 17:8; Phil 1:11; John 15:2-5
- v15 — Ps 18:2; Rom 9:14; Ps 62:6; Job 34:10; Ps 145:17

Psalm 93

The psalmist proclaims that the LORD reigns, robed in majesty and armed with strength, His throne established from all eternity. Mightier than the roaring seas, the LORD on high is supreme, and His statutes stand forever firm.

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| 1 | <i>The LORD reigneth, he is clothed with majesty; the LORD is clothed with strength, wherewith he hath girded himself: the world also is stablished, that it cannot be moved.</i> | The LORD reigns, He is robed in majesty; the LORD is robed in majesty and armed with strength; indeed, the world is established, firm and secure. |
| 2 | <i>Thy throne is established of old: thou art from everlasting.</i> | Your throne was established long ago; You are from all eternity. |
| 3 | <i>The floods have lifted up, O LORD, the floods have lifted up their voice; the floods lift up their waves.</i> | The seas have lifted up, LORD, the seas have lifted up their voice; the seas have lifted up their pounding waves. |
| 4 | <i>The LORD on high is mightier than the noise of many waters, yea, than the mighty waves of the sea.</i> | Mightier than the thunder of the great waters, mightier than the breakers of the sea — the LORD on high is mighty. |
| 5 | <i>Thy testimonies are very sure: holiness becometh thine house, O LORD, for ever.</i> | Your statutes, LORD, stand firm; holiness adorns Your house for endless days. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 96:10; 1 Chr 29:12; Rev 19:6; Ps 99:1; Ps 103:19
- v2 — Ps 45:6; Ps 90:2; Prov 8:22-23; Heb 13:8; Rev 1:8
- v3 — Ps 96:11; Ps 69:1-2; Ps 98:7-8; Isa 55:12; Isa 17:12-13

v4 — Ps 65:7; Ps 89:9

v5 — Ps 119:111; Ps 29:2; Ps 19:7-8; Lev 19:2; Ps 119:129

Psalm 94

The psalmist calls on the God of vengeance to rise up against the wicked who crush His people, slay the widow, and murder the fatherless. He finds comfort in knowing that the LORD will not abandon His inheritance, and that God's discipline brings blessing while the wicked face certain destruction.

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| 1 <i>O LORD God, to whom vengeance
belongeth; O God, to whom
vengeance belongeth, shew thyself.</i> | The LORD is a God Who avenges. O
God Who avenges, shine forth. |
| 2 <i>Lift up thyself, thou judge of the earth:
render a reward to the proud.</i> | Rise up, Judge of the earth; pay back to
the proud what they deserve. |
| 3 <i>LORD, how long shall the wicked,
how long shall the wicked triumph?</i> | How long, LORD, will the wicked,
how long will the wicked be jubilant? |
| 4 <i>How long shall they utter and speak
hard things? and all the workers of
iniquity boast themselves?</i> | They pour out arrogant words; all the
evildoers are full of boasting. |
| 5 <i>They break in pieces thy people, O
LORD, and afflict thine heritage.</i> | They crush Your people, LORD; they
oppress Your inheritance. |
| 6 <i>They slay the widow and the stranger,
and murder the fatherless.</i> | They slay the widow and the foreigner;
they murder the fatherless. |
| 7 <i>Yet they say, The LORD shall not see,
neither shall the God of Jacob regard
it.</i> | They say, "The LORD does not see;
the God of Jacob takes no notice." |
| 8 <i>Understand, ye brutish among the
people: and ye fools, when will ye be
wise?</i> | Take notice, You senseless ones
among the people; you fools, when
will you become wise? |
| 9 <i>He that planted the ear, shall he not
hear? he that formed the eye, shall he
not see?</i> | Does He who fashioned the ear not
hear? Does he who formed the eye not
see? |
| 10 <i>He that chastiseth the heathen, shall
not he correct? he that teacheth man
knowledge, shall not he know?</i> | Does He who disciplines nations not
punish? Does he who teaches mankind
lack knowledge? |

- 11 *The LORD knoweth the thoughts of man, that they are vanity.* The LORD knows the thoughts of man, that they are vanity.
- 12 *Blessed is the man whom thou chastenest, O LORD, and teachest him out of thy law;* Blessed is the one You discipline, LORD, the one You teach from Your law;
- 13 *That thou mayest give him rest from the days of adversity, until the pit be dugged for the wicked.* you grant them relief from days of trouble, till a pit is dug for the wicked.
- 14 *For the LORD will not cast off his people, neither will he forsake his inheritance.* For the LORD will not reject His people; He will never forsake His inheritance.
- 15 *But judgment shall return unto righteousness: and all the upright in heart shall follow it.* Judgment will again be founded on righteousness. All the upright in heart will follow it.
- 16 *Who will rise up for me against the evildoers? or who will stand up for me against the workers of iniquity?* Who will rise up for me against the wicked? Who will take a stand for me against evildoers?
- 17 *Unless the LORD had been my help, my soul had almost dwelt in silence.* Unless the LORD had given me help, I would soon have lived in the silence of death.
- 18 *When I said, My foot slippeth; thy mercy, O LORD, held me up.* When I said, "My foot slips," Your mercy, O LORD, held me up.
- 19 *In the multitude of my thoughts within me thy comforts delight my soul.* When anxiety was great within me, Your consolation brought me joy.
- 20 *Shall the throne of iniquity have fellowship with thee, which frameth mischief by a law?* Can a corrupt throne be allied with You — a throne that brings on misery by its decrees?
- 21 *They gather themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and condemn the innocent blood.* The wicked band together against the righteous and condemn the innocent to death.
- 22 *But the LORD is my defence; and my God is the rock of my refuge.* But the LORD has become my fortress, and my God the rock in whom I take refuge.

- 23

And he shall bring upon them their own iniquity, and shall cut them off in their own wickedness; yea, the LORD our God shall cut them off.
- He will repay them for their sins and destroy them for their wickedness; the LORD our God will destroy them.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 35:4; Nah 1:2; Rom 12:19; Deut 32:41-42; Deut 32:35
- v8 — Ps 92:6; Titus 3:3; Ps 49:10
- v9 — Ex 4:11; Jer 23:23-24; Prov 20:12; Ps 44:21; Ps 11:4
- v11 — 1 Cor 3:20; 1 Cor 1:19; 1 Cor 1:25; Rom 1:21-22; Job 11:11-12
- v12 — Prov 3:11-12; Job 5:17; Heb 12:5-11; 1 Cor 11:32; Ps 119:71
- v13 — Ps 55:23; 2 Pet 2:9; Ps 9:15; Isa 26:20-21; Hab 3:16
- v14 — 1 Sam 12:22; Ps 37:28; Rom 11:1-2; Rom 8:30; Deut 32:9
- v18 — Ps 121:3; Isa 41:10; Ps 119:116-117; Ps 37:23-24; Ps 38:16
- v19 — Ps 61:2; 2 Cor 1:4-5; Ps 77:2-10; Rom 5:2-5; Hab 3:16-18
- v20 — Isa 10:1; Ps 58:2; Eccl 3:16; Rev 13:15-17; John 11:57
- v22 — Ps 18:2; Ps 27:1-3; Ps 59:16-17; Ps 59:9; Ps 62:6
- v23 — Ps 7:16; Prov 2:22; Prov 14:32; Ps 55:23; Prov 5:22

Psalm 95

The psalmist calls the people to sing joyfully to the LORD, their Maker and Shepherd, and to worship before Him with thanksgiving. He warns them not to harden their hearts as Israel did at Meribah and Massah, where God swore in His wrath that the rebellious generation would never enter His rest.

- 1

O come, let us sing unto the LORD: let us make a joyful noise to the rock of our salvation.
- Come, let us sing for joy to the LORD; let us shout aloud to the Rock of our salvation.
- 2

Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving, and make a joyful noise unto him with psalms.
- Let us come before Him with thanksgiving and extol Him with music and song.
- 3

For the LORD is a great God, and a great King above all gods.
- For the LORD is the great God, the great King above all gods.
- 4

In his hand are the deep places of the earth: the strength of the hills is his also.
- In His hand are the depths of the earth, and the mountain peaks belong to Him.

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| 5 | <i>The sea is his, and he made it: and his hands formed the dry land.</i> | The sea is His, for He made it. His hands formed the dry land. |
| 6 | <i>O come, let us worship and bow down: let us kneel before the LORD our maker.</i> | Come, let us bow down in worship, let us kneel before the LORD our Maker; |
| 7 | <i>For he is our God; and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand. To day if ye will hear his voice,</i> | for He is our God and we are the people of his pasture, the flock under his care. Today, if only You would hear His voice, |
| 8 | <i>Harden not your heart, as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the wilderness:</i> | "Do not harden Your hearts as You did at Meribah, as You did that day at Massah in the wilderness, |
| 9 | <i>When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my work.</i> | when Your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my work. |
| 10 | <i>Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and said, It is a people that do err in their heart, and they have not known my ways:</i> | For forty years I was angry with that generation; I said, 'They are a people whose hearts go astray. They have not known my ways.' |
| 11 | <i>Unto whom I swear in my wrath that they should not enter into my rest.</i> | So I declared on oath in my anger, 'They shall never enter my rest.' " |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 10:4; Ps 81:1; 2 Sam 22:47; Ps 150:6; Ps 96:1-2
- v2 — Eph 5:19; Ps 100:4; Jer 31:12-13; Ps 105:2; Mic 6:6
- v3 — Ps 96:4; Jer 10:6-7; Ps 145:3; Ps 135:5; Ps 97:9
- v4 — Ps 135:6
- v5 — Gen 1:9-10
- v6 — Phil 2:10; Ps 100:3; Eph 3:14; Ps 95:1; 1 Cor 6:20
- v7 — Heb 4:7; Heb 3:15; Rev 3:20; Ps 48:14; Heb 3:7-11
- v8 — Ex 17:7; Heb 3:8-9; Num 20:13; Num 14:11; Num 14:22
- v9 — Num 14:22; 1 Cor 10:9
- v10 — Heb 3:17; Heb 3:9-10; Prov 1:22-29
- v11 — Heb 4:3; Heb 4:5; Heb 3:11; Num 14:23; Heb 3:18

Psalm 96

The psalmist calls all the earth to sing a new song to the LORD, declaring His glory among the nations and proclaiming that all other gods are mere idols. Creation itself — the heavens, the earth, the sea, and the trees of the forest — rejoices because the LORD comes to judge the world in righteousness.

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| 1 | <i>O sing unto the LORD a new song:
sing unto the LORD, all the earth.</i> | Sing to the LORD a new song; sing to
the LORD, all the earth. |
| 2 | <i>Sing unto the LORD, bless his name;
shew forth his salvation from day to
day.</i> | Sing to the LORD, praise His name;
proclaim His salvation day after day. |
| 3 | <i>Declare his glory among the heathen,
his wonders among all people.</i> | Declare His glory among the nations,
his marvelous deeds among all
peoples. |
| 4 | <i>For the LORD is great, and greatly to
be praised: he is to be feared above
all gods.</i> | For great is the LORD and most
worthy of praise; He is to be feared
above all gods. |
| 5 | <i>For all the gods of the nations are
idols: but the LORD made the
heavens.</i> | For all the gods of the nations are
idols. But The LORD made the
heavens. |
| 6 | <i>Honour and majesty are before him:
strength and beauty are in his
sanctuary.</i> | Splendor and majesty are before Him;
strength and glory are in His sanctuary. |
| 7 | <i>Give unto the LORD, O ye kindreds of
the people, give unto the LORD glory
and strength.</i> | Ascribe to the LORD, all You families
of nations, ascribe to the LORD glory
and strength. |
| 8 | <i>Give unto the LORD the glory due
unto his name: bring an offering, and
come into his courts.</i> | Ascribe to the LORD the glory due His
name; bring an offering and come into
His courts. |
| 9 | <i>O worship the LORD in the beauty of
holiness: fear before him, all the
earth.</i> | Worship the LORD in the splendor of
His holiness; tremble before Him, all
the earth. |
| 10 | <i>Say among the heathen that the LORD
reigneth: the world also shall be
established that it shall not be moved:
he shall judge the people righteously.</i> | Say among the nations, "The LORD
reigns." The world is firmly
established, it cannot be moved; He
will judge the peoples with equity. |

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| 11 <i>Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad; let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof.</i> | Let the heavens rejoice, let the earth be glad; let the sea resound. All that is in it. |
| 12 <i>Let the field be joyful, and all that is therein: then shall all the trees of the wood rejoice</i> | Let the fields be jubilant, and everything in them; let all the trees of the forest sing for joy. |
| 13 <i>Before the LORD: for he cometh, for he cometh to judge the earth: he shall judge the world with righteousness, and the people with his truth.</i> | Let all creation rejoice before the LORD, for He comes, He comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world in righteousness and the peoples in His faithfulness. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Chr 16:23-33; Ps 98:1; Ps 149:1; Ps 33:3; Rev 14:3
v3 — Luke 24:47; Dan 4:1-3; Ps 22:27; Isa 19:23-25
v4 — Ps 145:3; Rev 15:4; Jer 10:6-7; Ps 18:3; Ps 95:3
v5 — Ps 115:15; Isa 42:5
v6 — Ps 63:2-3; Ps 104:1; Ps 93:1; 2 Pet 1:16-17; Ps 29:1-2
v7 — Rev 19:1; Matt 6:13; Rev 5:9; 1 Chr 29:11-13; Rev 7:12
v8 — Ps 100:4; Rom 12:1; Ex 34:5-9
v9 — Ps 29:2; Ps 114:7; Ps 110:3
v10 — Ps 93:1; Ps 67:4; Ps 9:8; Acts 17:31; Ps 98:9-99:1
v11 — Isa 49:13; Ps 69:34; Ps 97:1; Ps 98:7-9
v12 — Isa 55:12-13; Isa 35:1; Isa 44:23; Isa 42:10-11; Ps 65:12-13
v13 — Rev 19:11; 2 Tim 4:8; Isa 25:8-9

Psalm 97

The psalmist proclaims that the LORD reigns in fire and lightning, melting mountains like wax and putting all idol-worshippers to shame. Zion rejoices at His judgments, and those who love the LORD are called to hate evil, for light and gladness are sown for the righteous.

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| 1 <i>The LORD reigneth; let the earth rejoice; let the multitude of isles be glad thereof.</i> | The LORD reigns, let the earth be glad; let the distant shores rejoice. |
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| <p>2 <i>Clouds and darkness are round about him: righteousness and judgment are the habitation of his throne.</i></p> <p>3 <i>A fire goeth before him, and burneth up his enemies round about.</i></p> <p>4 <i>His lightnings enlightened the world: the earth saw, and trembled.</i></p> <p>5 <i>The hills melted like wax at the presence of the LORD, at the presence of the Lord of the whole earth.</i></p> <p>6 <i>The heavens declare his righteousness, and all the people see his glory.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Confounded be all they that serve graven images, that boast themselves of idols: worship him, all ye gods.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Zion heard, and was glad; and the daughters of Judah rejoiced because of thy judgments, O LORD.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For thou, LORD, art high above all the earth: thou art exalted far above all gods.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Ye that love the LORD, hate evil: he preserveth the souls of his saints; he delivereth them out of the hand of the wicked.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Light is sown for the righteous, and gladness for the upright in heart.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Rejoice in the LORD, ye righteous; and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.</i></p> | <p>Clouds and thick darkness surround Him; righteousness and justice are the foundation of His throne.</p> <p>Fire goes before Him and consumes His foes on every side.</p> <p>His lightning lights up the world; the earth sees and trembles.</p> <p>The mountains melt like wax before the LORD, before the Lord of all the earth.</p> <p>The heavens proclaim His righteousness. All peoples see His glory.</p> <p>All who worship images are put to shame, those who boast in idols — worship Him, all You gods!</p> <p>Zion hears and rejoices and the villages of Judah are glad because of Your judgments, LORD.</p> <p>For You, LORD, are the Most High over all the earth; You are exalted far above all gods.</p> <p>Let those who love the LORD hate evil, for He guards the lives of His faithful ones and delivers them from the hand of the wicked.</p> <p>Light shines on the righteous and joy on the upright in heart.</p> <p>Rejoice in the LORD, You who are righteous, and praise His holy name.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 96:10-11; Ps 99:1; Col 1:13; Ps 98:4-6; Ps 93:1
- v2** — Ps 89:14; Ex 19:9; Prov 16:12; Heb 1:8-9; Nah 1:3
- v3** — Ps 50:3; Ps 18:8; Heb 12:29; 2 Thess 1:8; Mal 4:1
- v4** — Ps 77:18; Rev 11:19; Ex 19:16-18
- v5** — Nah 1:5; Mic 1:3-4; Isa 24:19-20; Isa 64:1-2; Hab 3:6
- v6** — Ps 50:6; Isa 66:18; Ps 19:1; 2 Sam 22:47
- v7** — Jer 10:14; Heb 1:6; Isa 42:17
- v8** — Ps 48:11
- v9** — Ps 95:3; Ps 83:18; Ex 18:11; Phil 2:9-11; Jer 10:10
- v10** — Prov 8:13; Rom 12:9; Jer 15:21; Ps 145:20; Ps 34:14
- v11** — Jas 5:7-11; John 12:46; Prov 4:18; Isa 60:1-2; Job 22:28
- v12** — Ps 30:4; Phil 4:4; Ps 32:11-33:1; Heb 12:10; Ps 60:6

Psalm 98

The psalmist calls for a new song because the LORD has revealed His salvation to the nations, remembering His mercy and truth toward Israel. All creation — the sea, the rivers, and the mountains — is summoned to shout for joy before the LORD who comes to judge the earth with righteousness and equity.

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| 1 | <i>O sing unto the LORD a new song; for he hath done marvellous things: his right hand, and his holy arm, hath gotten him the victory.</i> | Sing to the LORD a new song, for He has done marvelous things; His right hand and His holy arm have worked salvation for Him. |
| 2 | <i>The LORD hath made known his salvation: his righteousness hath he openly shewed in the sight of the heathen.</i> | The LORD has made His salvation known and revealed His righteousness to the nations. |
| 3 | <i>He hath remembered his mercy and his truth toward the house of Israel: all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.</i> | He has remembered His mercy and His truth toward the house of Israel; all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God. |
| 4 | <i>Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all the earth: make a loud noise, and rejoice, and sing praise.</i> | Shout for joy to the LORD, all the earth, burst into jubilant song with music; |
| 5 | <i>Sing unto the LORD with the harp; with the harp, and the voice of a psalm.</i> | make music to the LORD with the harp, with the harp and the sound of singing, |

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| 6 | <i>With trumpets and sound of cornet
make a joyful noise before the LORD,
the King.</i> | with trumpets and the blast of the ram's
horn — shout for joy before the
LORD, the King. |
| 7 | <i>Let the sea roar, and the fulness
thereof; the world, and they that dwell
therein.</i> | Let the sea resound, and everything in
it, the world. All who live in it. |
| 8 | <i>Let the floods clap their hands: let the
hills be joyful together</i> | Let the rivers clap their hands, let the
mountains sing together for joy; |
| 9 | <i>Before the LORD; for he cometh to
judge the earth: with righteousness
shall he judge the world, and the
people with equity.</i> | let them sing before the LORD, for He
comes to judge the earth. He will judge
the world in righteousness and the
peoples with equity. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 15:6; Isa 52:10; Ps 33:3; Rev 14:3; Ps 96:3
v2 — Isa 52:10; Isa 62:2; Ps 22:31; Rom 3:21-26; Rom 1:17
v3 — Ps 22:27; Acts 13:47
v4 — Isa 44:23; Rev 19:6; Ps 95:1; Ps 66:1; Ps 100:1
v7 — Isa 49:13
v8 — Isa 55:12; Ps 89:12; Ps 65:12-13; Ps 93:3; Ps 47:1
v9 — Ps 96:13; Ps 96:10; Acts 17:31

Psalm 99

The psalmist declares that the LORD reigns from His throne between the cherubim, exalted over all the nations in holiness. Moses, Aaron, and Samuel called on Him and He answered; He is a God who forgives yet also punishes wrongdoing.

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| 1 | <i>The LORD reigneth; let the people
tremble: he sitteth between the
cherubims; let the earth be moved.</i> | The LORD reigns, let the nations
tremble; he sits enthroned between the
cherubim, let the earth shake. |
| 2 | <i>The LORD is great in Zion; and he is
high above all the people.</i> | Great is the LORD in Zion; He is
exalted over all the nations. |
| 3 | <i>Let them praise thy great and terrible
name; for it is holy.</i> | Let them praise Your great and
awesome name — he is holy. |

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| <p>4 <i>The king's strength also loveth judgment; thou dost establish equity, thou executest judgment and righteousness in Jacob.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Exalt ye the LORD our God, and worship at his footstool; for he is holy.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Moses and Aaron among his priests, and Samuel among them that call upon his name; they called upon the LORD, and he answered them.</i></p> <p>7 <i>He spake unto them in the cloudy pillar: they kept his testimonies, and the ordinance that he gave them.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Thou answeredst them, O LORD our God: thou wast a God that forgavest them, though thou tookest vengeance of their inventions.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Exalt the LORD our God, and worship at his holy hill; for the LORD our God is holy.</i></p> | <p>The King is mighty, he loves justice — you have established equity; in Jacob you have done what is just and right.</p> <p>Exalt the LORD our God and worship at His footstool; He is holy.</p> <p>Moses and Aaron were among his priests, Samuel was among those who called on his name; they called on the LORD and He answered them.</p> <p>He spoke to them from the pillar of cloud; they kept His statutes and the decrees He gave them.</p> <p>LORD our God, You answered them; You were to Israel a forgiving God, though You punished their misdeeds.</p> <p>Exalt the LORD our God and worship at His holy mountain, for the LORD our God is holy.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 97:1; Ex 25:22; Ps 93:1; Ps 80:1; Ps 97:4
- v2 — Ps 97:9
- v3 — Isa 6:3; Deut 28:58
- v4 — Ps 11:7; Jer 23:5; Job 36:5-7
- v5 — Ps 132:7; Isa 66:1; Ps 34:3; Ps 108:5; Ex 15:2
- v6 — Jer 15:1
- v7 — Ex 33:9; Num 12:5
- v8 — Num 20:12
- v9 — Luke 1:49; Isa 57:15

Psalm 100

A Psalm of praise.

The psalmist calls all the earth to shout for joy and worship the LORD with gladness, entering His gates with thanksgiving and His courts with praise. He declares that the LORD is good, His mercy everlasting, and His truth endures to all generations.

1	<i>Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all ye lands.</i>	Shout for joy to the LORD, all the earth.
2	<i>Serve the LORD with gladness: come before his presence with singing.</i>	Worship the LORD with gladness; come before Him with joyful songs.
3	<i>Know ye that the LORD he is God: it is he that hath made us, and not we ourselves; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.</i>	Know that the LORD is God. It is He who made us. We are his; we are his people, the sheep of His pasture.
4	<i>Enter into his gates with thanksgiving, and into his courts with praise: be thankful unto him, and bless his name.</i>	Enter His gates with thanksgiving and His courts with praise; give thanks to Him and praise His name.
5	<i>For the LORD is good; his mercy is everlasting; and his truth endureth to all generations.</i>	For the LORD is good; His mercy is everlasting, and His truth endures to all generations.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 98:4; Luke 19:37; Zeph 3:14; Ps 95:1-2; Ps 32:11
- v2 — Phil 4:4; Ps 95:2; Ps 71:23; Acts 2:46-47; 2 Chr 20:27-28
- v3 — Ps 95:6-7; Ps 46:10; Ps 119:73; John 17:3; Eph 2:10
- v4 — Col 3:16-17; Heb 13:15; 1 Chr 29:13; Ps 103:1-2; Ps 116:17-19
- v5 — Ps 106:1; Ps 86:5; Ps 107:1; Ps 36:5; 1 Chr 16:34

Psalm 101

A Psalm of David.

David pledges to conduct himself and his household with integrity, refusing to set any wicked thing before his eyes and cutting off slanderers and the proud. He resolves to surround himself with the faithful and to banish all deceit and wickedness from the city of the LORD.

1	<i>I will sing of mercy and judgment: unto thee, O LORD, will I sing.</i>	I will sing of mercy and judgment; to You, O LORD, I will sing.
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| <p>2 <i>I will behave myself wisely in a perfect way. O when wilt thou come unto me? I will walk within my house with a perfect heart.</i></p> <p>3 <i>I will set no wicked thing before mine eyes: I hate the work of them that turn aside; it shall not cleave to me.</i></p> <p>4 <i>A froward heart shall depart from me: I will not know a wicked person.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Whoso privily slandereth his neighbour, him will I cut off: him that hath an high look and a proud heart will not I suffer.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Mine eyes shall be upon the faithful of the land, that they may dwell with me: he that walketh in a perfect way, he shall serve me.</i></p> <p>7 <i>He that worketh deceit shall not dwell within my house: he that telleth lies shall not tarry in my sight.</i></p> <p>8 <i>I will early destroy all the wicked of the land; that I may cut off all wicked doers from the city of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>I will be careful to lead a blameless life — when will You come to me? I will conduct the affairs of my house with a blameless heart.</p> <p>I will not look with approval on anything that is vile. I hate what faithless people do; I will have no part in it.</p> <p>The perverse of heart shall be far from me; I will have nothing to do with what is evil.</p> <p>Whoever slanders their neighbor in secret, I will put to silence; whoever has haughty eyes and a proud heart, I will not tolerate.</p> <p>My eyes will be on the faithful in the land, that they may dwell with me; the one whose walk is blameless will minister to me.</p> <p>No one who practices deceit will dwell in my house; no one who speaks falsely will stand in my presence.</p> <p>Every morning I will put to silence all the wicked in the land; I will cut off every evildoer from the city of the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 89:1; Ps 145:7; Ps 71:22-23; Rev 19:1-3
- v2 — Ps 119:106; 1 Kgs 9:4; 1 Tim 3:4-5
- v3 — Ps 119:37; Job 31:1; Jas 1:13-15; 2 Sam 11:2-3; Prov 6:25
- v4 — Prov 11:20
- v5 — Ps 15:3; Ps 18:27
- v6 — Ps 119:63; Luke 12:43-44; Rev 21:3; John 12:26; Ps 119:1-3

v7 — Acts 5:1-10

v8 — Ps 75:10; Jer 21:12; Prov 16:12; Ps 48:8; Prov 20:26

Psalm 102

A Prayer of the afflicted, when he is overwhelmed, and pours out his complaint before the LORD.

The afflicted psalmist pours out his complaint, describing his days vanishing like smoke and his body wasting away in lonely grief. Yet he turns from his suffering to God's eternal throne, trusting that the LORD will rebuild Zion, appear in glory, and show compassion on a future generation.

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| 1 | <i>Hear my prayer, O LORD, and let my cry come unto thee.</i> | Hear my prayer, LORD; let my cry for help come to You. |
| 2 | <i>Hide not thy face from me in the day when I am in trouble; incline thine ear unto me: in the day when I call answer me speedily.</i> | Do not hide Your face from me when I am in distress. Turn Your ear to me; when I call, answer me quickly. |
| 3 | <i>For my days are consumed like smoke, and my bones are burned as an hearth.</i> | For my days vanish like smoke; my bones burn like glowing embers. |
| 4 | <i>My heart is smitten, and withered like grass; so that I forget to eat my bread.</i> | My heart is blighted and withered like grass; I forget to eat my food. |
| 5 | <i>By reason of the voice of my groaning my bones cleave to my skin.</i> | In my distress I groan aloud and am reduced to skin and bones. |
| 6 | <i>I am like a pelican of the wilderness: I am like an owl of the desert.</i> | I am like a desert owl, like an owl among the ruins. |
| 7 | <i>I watch, and am as a sparrow alone upon the house top.</i> | I lie awake; I have become like a bird alone on a rooftop. |
| 8 | <i>Mine enemies reproach me all the day; and they that are mad against me are sworn against me.</i> | All day long my enemies taunt me; those who rail against me use my name as a curse. |
| 9 | <i>For I have eaten ashes like bread, and mingled my drink with weeping.</i> | For I eat ashes as my food and mingle my drink with tears |

- 10 *Because of thine indignation and thy wrath: for thou hast lifted me up, and cast me down.* because of Your great wrath, for You have taken me up and thrown me aside.
- 11 *My days are like a shadow that declineth; and I am withered like grass.* My days are like the evening shadow; I wither away like grass.
- 12 *But thou, O LORD, shall endure for ever; and thy remembrance unto all generations.* But You, LORD, sit enthroned forever; Your renown endures through all generations.
- 13 *Thou shalt arise, and have mercy upon Zion: for the time to favour her, yea, the set time, is come.* You will arise and have compassion on Zion, for it is time to show favor to her; the appointed time has come.
- 14 *For thy servants take pleasure in her stones, and favour the dust thereof.* For her stones are dear to Your servants; her very dust moves them to pity.
- 15 *So the heathen shall fear the name of the LORD, and all the kings of the earth thy glory.* The nations will fear the name of the LORD, all the kings of the earth will revere Your glory.
- 16 *When the LORD shall build up Zion, he shall appear in his glory.* For the LORD will rebuild Zion and appear in His glory.
- 17 *He will regard the prayer of the destitute, and not despise their prayer.* He will respond to the prayer of the destitute; He will not despise their plea.
- 18 *This shall be written for the generation to come: and the people which shall be created shall praise the LORD.* Let this be written for a future generation, that a people not yet created may praise the LORD.
- 19 *For he hath looked down from the height of his sanctuary; from heaven did the LORD behold the earth;* The LORD looked down from His sanctuary on high, from heaven He viewed the earth,
- 20 *To hear the groaning of the prisoner; to loose those that are appointed to death;* to hear the groans of the prisoners and release those condemned to death.

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| 21 <i>To declare the name of the LORD in Zion, and his praise in Jerusalem;</i> | So the name of the LORD will be declared in Zion and His praise in Jerusalem |
| 22 <i>When the people are gathered together, and the kingdoms, to serve the LORD.</i> | when the peoples and the kingdoms assemble to worship the LORD. |
| 23 <i>He weakened my strength in the way; he shortened my days.</i> | In the course of my life He broke my strength; He cut short my days. |
| 24 <i>I said, O my God, take me not away in the midst of my days: thy years are throughout all generations.</i> | So I said: "Do not take me away, my God, in the midst of my days; Your years go on through all generations. |
| 25 <i>Of old hast thou laid the foundation of the earth: and the heavens are the work of thy hands.</i> | In the beginning You laid the foundations of the earth, and the heavens are the work of Your hands. |
| 26 <i>They shall perish, but thou shalt endure: yea, all of them shall wax old like a garment; as a vesture shalt thou change them, and they shall be changed:</i> | They will perish, but You remain; they will all wear out like a garment. Like clothing You will change them and they will be discarded. |
| 27 <i>But thou art the same, and thy years shall have no end.</i> | But You remain the same, and Your years will never end. |
| 28 <i>The children of thy servants shall continue, and their seed shall be established before thee.</i> | The children of Your servants will live in Your presence; their descendants will be established before You." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 18:6; Ps 130:1-2; Ex 2:23; Ps 61:2; Ps 142:2-3
v2 — Ps 69:17; Ps 27:9; Ps 70:1; Isa 8:17
v12 — Ps 135:13; Ex 3:15; Heb 13:8; Lam 5:19; Ps 9:7
v13 — Gal 4:4; Isa 60:1; Isa 40:2; Ps 44:26; Zech 2:10-12
v15 — 1 Kgs 8:43; Ps 138:4; Isa 60:3-22
v17 — Neh 1:6; Ps 22:24; Jer 29:11-14; Ps 72:12; Ps 9:18
v18 — Ps 22:30-31; Rom 15:4; Isa 43:21; Ps 78:4-6; 1 Pet 2:9-10
v19 — Deut 26:15; Ps 14:2

v20 — Ps 79:11; Ps 146:7; Ex 3:7; Isa 61:1-3; 2 Kgs 13:22-23
v25 — Gen 1:1; Ex 20:11; Heb 1:10-12; Jer 32:17; Heb 3:3-4
v26 — Isa 51:6; Matt 24:35; Luke 21:33; Isa 34:4; Rev 20:11
v27 — Heb 13:8; Mal 3:6; Jas 1:17; Rev 1:8; Rev 1:17-18

Psalm 103

A Psalm of David.

David calls his soul to bless the LORD, cataloging God's benefits — forgiveness, healing, redemption, lovingkindness, and the renewal of youth. He celebrates God's mercy, which is as high as the heavens, His compassion like a father's, and His covenant love that endures from everlasting to everlasting on those who fear Him.

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| 1 | <i>Bless the LORD, O my soul: and all that is within me, bless his holy name.</i> | Praise the LORD, my soul; all my inmost being, praise His holy name. |
| 2 | <i>Bless the LORD, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits:</i> | Praise the LORD, my soul, and forget not all His benefits — |
| 3 | <i>Who forgiveth all thine iniquities; who healeth all thy diseases;</i> | who forgives all Your sins and heals all Your diseases, |
| 4 | <i>Who redeemeth thy life from destruction; who crowneth thee with lovingkindness and tender mercies;</i> | who redeems Your life from destruction, who crowns You with lovingkindness and tender mercies, |
| 5 | <i>Who satisfieth thy mouth with good things; so that thy youth is renewed like the eagle's.</i> | who satisfies Your desires with good things so that Your youth is renewed like the eagle's. |
| 6 | <i>The LORD executeth righteousness and judgment for all that are oppressed.</i> | The LORD works righteousness and justice for all the oppressed. |
| 7 | <i>He made known his ways unto Moses, his acts unto the children of Israel.</i> | He made known his ways to Moses, his deeds to the people of Israel. |
| 8 | <i>The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and plenteous in mercy.</i> | The LORD is merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and plenteous in mercy. |
| 9 | <i>He will not always chide: neither will he keep his anger for ever.</i> | He will not always accuse, nor will He harbor His anger forever; |

- 10 *He hath not dealt with us after our sins; nor rewarded us according to our iniquities.* he does not treat us as our sins deserve or repay us according to our iniquities.
- 11 *For as the heaven is high above the earth, so great is his mercy toward them that fear him.* For as the heavens are high above the earth, so great is His mercy toward those who fear Him.
- 12 *As far as the east is from the west, so far hath he removed our transgressions from us.* as far as the east is from the west, so far has He removed our transgressions from us.
- 13 *Like as a father pitieth his children, so the LORD pitieth them that fear him.* As a father has compassion on His children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him;
- 14 *For he knoweth our frame; he remembereth that we are dust.* for He knows how we are formed, He remembers that we are dust.
- 15 *As for man, his days are as grass: as a flower of the field, so he flourisheth.* As for man, His days are as grass; as a flower of the field, so He flourishes.
- 16 *For the wind passeth over it, and it is gone; and the place thereof shall know it no more.* the wind blows over it and it is gone, and its place remembers it no more.
- 17 *But the mercy of the LORD is from everlasting to everlasting upon them that fear him, and his righteousness unto children's children;* But the mercy of the LORD is from everlasting to everlasting on those who fear Him, and His righteousness to children's children,
- 18 *To such as keep his covenant, and to those that remember his commandments to do them.* with those who keep His covenant and remember to obey His precepts.
- 19 *The LORD hath prepared his throne in the heavens; and his kingdom ruleth over all.* The LORD has established His throne in heaven. His kingdom rules over all.
- 20 *Bless the LORD, ye his angels, that excel in strength, that do his commandments, hearkening unto the voice of his word.* Praise the LORD, You His angels, You mighty ones who do His bidding, who obey His word.

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| <p>21 <i>Bless ye the LORD, all ye his hosts; ye ministers of his, that do his pleasure.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Bless the LORD, all his works in all places of his dominion: bless the LORD, O my soul.</i></p> | <p>Praise the LORD, all His heavenly hosts, You His servants who do his will.</p> <p>Praise the LORD, all His works everywhere in His dominion. Praise the LORD, my soul.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 146:1-2; Ps 57:7-11; John 4:24; Ps 111:1; 1 Cor 14:15
v2 — Ps 116:12; Isa 63:7; Ps 105:5; Luke 17:15-18; Deut 6:12
v3 — Ex 15:26; Isa 53:5; Jer 17:14; Ps 30:2; Ps 41:3-4
v4 — Ps 56:13; Ps 71:23; Ps 103:12; Ps 34:22; Ps 8:5
v5 — Isa 40:31; Ps 107:9; 1 Tim 6:17; 2 Cor 4:16; Ps 63:5
v8 — Ps 86:15; Joel 2:13; Ex 34:6-7; Ps 145:8; Nah 1:3
v10 — Ezra 9:13; Neh 9:31; Lam 3:22; Ps 130:3; Dan 9:18-19
v11 — Ps 57:10; Luke 1:50; Eph 2:4-7; Ps 103:17; Ps 36:5
v12 — Isa 43:25; 1 John 1:7; Mic 7:18; Isa 38:17; Jer 31:34
v13 — Luke 11:11-12; Heb 12:5-11; Ps 103:17; Luke 15:21-22; Jer 31:20
v19 — Ps 47:2; Phil 2:9-10; Ps 9:7; Ps 11:4; 1 Pet 3:22
v20 — Heb 1:14; Ps 148:2; Luke 1:19; Matt 26:53; 2 Kgs 19:35

Psalm 104

The psalmist praises God as Creator, sweeping from the foundations of the earth to the waters, the animals, the forests, the sea, and Leviathan playing in the deep. All creatures depend on God's open hand for life, and the psalmist vows to sing to the LORD as long as he lives.

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| <p>1 <i>Bless the LORD, O my soul. O LORD my God, thou art very great; thou art clothed with honour and majesty.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Who coverest thyself with light as with a garment: who stretchest out the heavens like a curtain:</i></p> <p>3 <i>Who layeth the beams of his chambers in the waters: who maketh the clouds his chariot: who walketh upon the wings of the wind:</i></p> | <p>Praise the LORD, my soul. LORD my God, You are very great; You are clothed with splendor and majesty.</p> <p>The LORD wraps Himself in light as with a garment; He stretches out the heavens like a tent</p> <p>lays the beams of His upper chambers on their waters. He makes the clouds his chariot and rides on the wings of the wind.</p> |
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| 4 | <i>Who maketh his angels spirits; his ministers a flaming fire:</i> | He makes winds His messengers, flames of fire His servants. |
| 5 | <i>Who laid the foundations of the earth, that it should not be removed for ever.</i> | He set the earth on its foundations; it can never be moved. |
| 6 | <i>Thou coveredst it with the deep as with a garment: the waters stood above the mountains.</i> | You covered it with the watery depths as with a garment; the waters stood above the mountains. |
| 7 | <i>At thy rebuke they fled; at the voice of thy thunder they hasted away.</i> | But at Your rebuke the waters fled, at the sound of Your thunder they took to flight; |
| 8 | <i>They go up by the mountains; they go down by the valleys unto the place which thou hast founded for them.</i> | they flowed over the mountains, they went down into the valleys, to the place You assigned for them. |
| 9 | <i>Thou hast set a bound that they may not pass over; that they turn not again to cover the earth.</i> | You set a boundary they cannot cross; never again will they cover the earth. |
| 10 | <i>He sendeth the springs into the valleys, which run among the hills.</i> | He makes springs pour water into the ravines; it flows between the mountains. |
| 11 | <i>They give drink to every beast of the field: the wild asses quench their thirst.</i> | They give water to all the animals of the wild; the wild donkeys quench their thirst. |
| 12 | <i>By them shall the fowls of the heaven have their habitation, which sing among the branches.</i> | The birds of the sky nest by the waters; they sing among the branches. |
| 13 | <i>He watereth the hills from his chambers: the earth is satisfied with the fruit of thy works.</i> | He waters the mountains from His upper chambers; the land is satisfied by the fruit of His work. |
| 14 | <i>He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and herb for the service of man: that he may bring forth food out of the earth;</i> | He makes grass grow for the cattle, and plants for people to cultivate — bringing forth food from the earth: |

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| 15 <i>And wine that maketh glad the heart of man, and oil to make his face to shine, and bread which strengtheneth man's heart.</i> | and wine that makes glad the heart of man, and oil to make His face shine, and bread which strengthens man's heart. |
| 16 <i>The trees of the LORD are full of sap; the cedars of Lebanon, which he hath planted;</i> | The trees of the LORD are well watered, the cedars of Lebanon that He planted. |
| 17 <i>Where the birds make their nests: as for the stork, the fir trees are her house.</i> | There the birds make their nests; the stork has its home in the junipers. |
| 18 <i>The high hills are a refuge for the wild goats; and the rocks for the conies.</i> | The high mountains belong to the wild goats; the crags are a refuge for the hyrax. |
| 19 <i>He appointed the moon for seasons: the sun knoweth his going down.</i> | He made the moon to mark the seasons, and the sun knows when to go down. |
| 20 <i>Thou makest darkness, and it is night: wherein all the beasts of the forest do creep forth.</i> | You bring darkness, it becomes night. All the beasts of the forest prowl. |
| 21 <i>The young lions roar after their prey, and seek their meat from God.</i> | The lions roar for their prey and seek their food from God. |
| 22 <i>The sun ariseth, they gather themselves together, and lay them down in their dens.</i> | The sun rises. They steal away; they return and lie down in their dens. |
| 23 <i>Man goeth forth unto his work and to his labour until the evening.</i> | Then people go out to their work, to their labor until evening. |
| 24 <i>O LORD, how manifold are thy works! in wisdom hast thou made them all: the earth is full of thy riches.</i> | How many are Your works, LORD! In wisdom You made them all; the earth is full of Your creatures. |
| 25 <i>So is this great and wide sea, wherein are things creeping innumerable, both small and great beasts.</i> | There is the sea, vast and spacious, teeming with creatures beyond number — living things both large and small. |

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| <p>26 <i>There go the ships: there is that leviathan, whom thou hast made to play therein.</i></p> <p>27 <i>These wait all upon thee; that thou mayest give them their meat in due season.</i></p> <p>28 <i>That thou givest them they gather: thou openest thine hand, they are filled with good.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Thou hidest thy face, they are troubled: thou takest away their breath, they die, and return to their dust.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Thou sendest forth thy spirit, they are created: and thou renewest the face of the earth.</i></p> <p>31 <i>The glory of the LORD shall endure for ever: the LORD shall rejoice in his works.</i></p> <p>32 <i>He looketh on the earth, and it trembleth: he toucheth the hills, and they smoke.</i></p> <p>33 <i>I will sing unto the LORD as long as I live: I will sing praise to my God while I have my being.</i></p> <p>34 <i>My meditation of him shall be sweet: I will be glad in the LORD.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Let the sinners be consumed out of the earth, and let the wicked be no more. Bless thou the LORD, O my soul. Praise ye the LORD.</i></p> | <p>There the ships go to and fro, and Leviathan, which You formed to frolic there.</p> <p>All creatures look to You to give them their food at the proper time.</p> <p>When You give it to them, they gather it up; when You open Your hand, they are satisfied with good things.</p> <p>When You hide Your face, they are terrified; when You take away their breath, they die and return to the dust.</p> <p>When You send Your Spirit, they are created, and You renew the face of the ground.</p> <p>May the glory of the LORD endure forever; may the LORD rejoice in His works —</p> <p>he who looks at the earth. It trembles, who touches the mountains. They smoke.</p> <p>I will sing to the LORD all my life; I will sing praise to my God as long as I live.</p> <p>May my meditation be pleasing to Him, as I rejoice in the LORD.</p> <p>But may sinners vanish from the earth and the wicked be no more. Praise the LORD, my soul. Praise the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 103:22; Ps 145:3; Ps 96:6; Ps 93:1; Ps 103:1-2
- v3 — Amos 9:6; 2 Sam 22:11; Isa 19:1; Ps 18:10-11; Nah 1:3
- v4 — Heb 1:7; 2 Kgs 2:11; 2 Kgs 6:17; Heb 1:14; Ps 148:8
- v5 — Job 26:7; Ps 24:2; Ps 33:9; Ps 96:10; Ps 136:6
- v14 — Ps 136:25; Ps 147:8-9; Job 28:5; Ps 145:15-16; 1 Cor 3:7
- v15 — Ps 23:5; Eccl 10:19; Eccl 9:7; Judg 9:13
- v24 — Jer 10:12; Ps 40:5; Ps 50:10-12; Eph 3:10; Rom 11:33
- v27 — Ps 136:25; Ps 147:9; Job 38:41; Luke 12:24-28; Ps 145:15-16
- v30 — Job 33:4; Ezek 37:9; Rev 21:5; Job 26:13; Ps 33:6
- v33 — Ps 63:4; Ps 146:2; Ps 145:1-2
- v34 — Hab 3:17-18; Phil 4:4; Ps 119:15-16; Ps 119:127-128; Ps 1:2
- v35 — Ps 103:22-104:1; Ps 106:48; Rev 19:1-2; Ps 37:38; Ps 68:1-2

Psalm 105

The psalmist recounts God's faithfulness to His covenant with Abraham, tracing His providential hand through the stories of Joseph, the plagues of Egypt, the exodus, and the wilderness provision. The purpose of all God's mighty works is that His people might keep His statutes and observe His laws.

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| 1 | <i>O give thanks unto the LORD; call upon his name: make known his deeds among the people.</i> | Give praise to the LORD, proclaim His name; make known among the nations what he has done. |
| 2 | <i>Sing unto him, sing psalms unto him: talk ye of all his wondrous works.</i> | Sing to Him, sing praise to Him; tell of all His wonderful acts. |
| 3 | <i>Glory ye in his holy name: let the heart of them rejoice that seek the LORD.</i> | Glory in His holy name; let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice. |
| 4 | <i>Seek the LORD, and his strength: seek his face evermore.</i> | Look to the LORD and His strength; seek His face always. |
| 5 | <i>Remember his marvellous works that he hath done; his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth;</i> | Remember the wonders He has done, His miracles, and the judgments He pronounced, |
| 6 | <i>O ye seed of Abraham his servant, ye children of Jacob his chosen.</i> | you his servants, the descendants of Abraham, his chosen ones, the children of Jacob. |
| 7 | <i>He is the LORD our God: his judgments are in all the earth.</i> | He is the LORD our God; His judgments are in all the earth. |

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| 8 <i>He hath remembered his covenant for ever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations.</i> | He remembers His covenant forever, the promise He made, for a thousand generations, |
| 9 <i>Which covenant he made with Abraham, and his oath unto Isaac;</i> | the covenant he made with Abraham, the oath he swore to Isaac. |
| 10 <i>And confirmed the same unto Jacob for a law, and to Israel for an everlasting covenant:</i> | He confirmed it to Jacob as a decree, to Israel as an everlasting covenant: |
| 11 <i>Saying, Unto thee will I give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance:</i> | "To you I will give the land of Canaan as the portion you will inherit." |
| 12 <i>When they were but a few men in number; yea, very few, and strangers in it.</i> | When they were but few in number, few indeed, and strangers in it, |
| 13 <i>When they went from one nation to another, from one kingdom to another people;</i> | they wandered from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another. |
| 14 <i>He suffered no man to do them wrong: yea, he reprov'd kings for their sakes;</i> | He allowed no one to oppress them; for their sake he rebuked kings: |
| 15 <i>Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm.</i> | Saying, "Touch not my anointed, and do my prophets no harm." |
| 16 <i>Moreover he called for a famine upon the land: he brake the whole staff of bread.</i> | He called down famine on the land and destroyed all their supplies of food; |
| 17 <i>He sent a man before them, even Joseph, who was sold for a servant:</i> | he sent a man before them — Joseph, sold as a slave. |
| 18 <i>Whose feet they hurt with fetters: he was laid in iron:</i> | They bruised his feet with shackles, his neck was put in irons, |
| 19 <i>Until the time that his word came: the word of the LORD tried him.</i> | till what He foretold came to pass, till the word of the LORD proved Him true. |
| 20 <i>The king sent and loosed him; even the ruler of the people, and let him go free.</i> | The king sent and released him, the ruler of peoples set him free. |

- 21 *He made him lord of his house, and ruler of all his substance:* He made him master of his household, ruler over all he possessed,
- 22 *To bind his princes at his pleasure; and teach his senators wisdom.* to instruct his princes as he pleased and teach his elders wisdom.
- 23 *Israel also came into Egypt; and Jacob sojourned in the land of Ham.* Then Israel entered Egypt; Jacob lived as a foreigner in the land of Ham.
- 24 *And he increased his people greatly; and made them stronger than their enemies.* The LORD made His people very fruitful; He made them too numerous for their foes,
- 25 *He turned their heart to hate his people, to deal subtilly with his servants.* whose hearts He turned to hate His people, to conspire against His servants.
- 26 *He sent Moses his servant; and Aaron whom he had chosen.* He sent Moses his servant, and Aaron, whom he had chosen.
- 27 *They shewed his signs among them, and wonders in the land of Ham.* They performed his signs among them, his wonders in the land of Ham.
- 28 *He sent darkness, and made it dark; and they rebelled not against his word.* He sent darkness and made the land dark — for had they not rebelled against his words?
- 29 *He turned their waters into blood, and slew their fish.* He turned their waters into blood, causing their fish to die.
- 30 *Their land brought forth frogs in abundance, in the chambers of their kings.* Their land teemed with frogs, which went up into the bedrooms of their rulers.
- 31 *He spake, and there came divers sorts of flies, and lice in all their coasts.* He spoke, and there came swarms of flies, and gnats throughout their country.
- 32 *He gave them hail for rain, and flaming fire in their land.* He turned their rain into hail, with lightning throughout their land;
- 33 *He smote their vines also and their fig trees; and brake the trees of their coasts.* he struck down their vines and fig trees and shattered the trees of their country.

- 34 *He spake, and the locusts came, and caterpillars, and that without number,* He spoke, and the locusts came, grasshoppers without number;
- 35 *And did eat up all the herbs in their land, and devoured the fruit of their ground.* they ate up every green thing in their land, ate up the produce of their soil.
- 36 *He smote also all the firstborn in their land, the chief of all their strength.* Then he struck down all the firstborn in their land, the firstfruits of all their manhood.
- 37 *He brought them forth also with silver and gold: and there was not one feeble person among their tribes.* He brought out Israel, laden with silver and gold, and from among their tribes no one faltered.
- 38 *Egypt was glad when they departed: for the fear of them fell upon them.* Egypt was glad when they left, because dread of Israel had fallen on them.
- 39 *He spread a cloud for a covering; and fire to give light in the night.* He spread out a cloud as a covering, and a fire to give light at night.
- 40 *The people asked, and he brought quails, and satisfied them with the bread of heaven.* They asked. He brought them quail; he fed them well with the bread of heaven.
- 41 *He opened the rock, and the waters gushed out; they ran in the dry places like a river.* He opened the rock, and water gushed out; it flowed like a river in the desert.
- 42 *For he remembered his holy promise, and Abraham his servant.* For he remembered his holy promise given to his servant Abraham.
- 43 *And he brought forth his people with joy, and his chosen with gladness:* He brought out his people with rejoicing, his chosen ones with shouts of joy;
- 44 *And gave them the lands of the heathen: and they inherited the labour of the people;* he gave them the lands of the nations. They fell heir to what others had toiled for —
- 45 *That they might observe his statutes, and keep his laws. Praise ye the LORD.* that they might keep His precepts and observe His laws. Praise the LORD.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 12:4; Rom 10:13; Ps 145:11-12; Ps 106:1; 1 Chr 16:34
- v2 — Isa 12:5-6; Ps 119:27; Ps 77:12; Ps 98:5; Ps 98:1
- v3 — Lam 3:25; Gal 6:14; 1 Cor 1:29; Prov 8:17; 1 Cor 1:31
- v4 — Ps 27:8; Zeph 2:2-3; Amos 5:4-6; 2 Chr 6:41; Ps 132:8
- v5 — Ps 77:11; Ps 119:13; Luke 22:19; Isa 43:18-19; Rev 16:7
- v8 — Deut 7:9; Luke 1:72-74; Ps 106:45; Ps 111:5; Ps 105:42
- v11 — Gen 15:18; Gen 13:15; Ps 78:55; Gen 28:13; Gen 26:3-4
- v12 — Deut 7:7; Gen 34:30; Heb 11:9; Gen 23:4
- v15 — Zech 2:8; Gen 26:11; Gen 20:7; 1 John 2:27; Gen 49:8-33
- v19 — Acts 7:10; Prov 21:1; Gen 40:20-21; Gen 41:25; Gen 41:11-16
- v37 — Ex 12:35-36; Ex 3:22; Acts 13:17; Gen 15:14
- v39 — Neh 9:12; Isa 4:5; Ps 78:14; Ex 13:21-22; Ex 14:24

Psalm 106

The psalmist confesses Israel's long history of sin — from the Red Sea to the golden calf, from Baal-peor to the sacrifice of children to idols — showing a repeating cycle of rebellion, judgment, and God's merciful deliverance. Despite it all, God remembers His covenant and relents according to the multitude of His mercies.

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| 1 | <i>Praise ye the LORD. O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Praise the LORD. Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; His mercy endures forever. |
| 2 | <i>Who can utter the mighty acts of the LORD? who can shew forth all his praise?</i> | Who can proclaim the mighty acts of the LORD or fully declare His praise? |
| 3 | <i>Blessed are they that keep judgment, and he that doeth righteousness at all times.</i> | Blessed are those who act justly, who always do what is right. |
| 4 | <i>Remember me, O LORD, with the favour that thou bearest unto thy people: O visit me with thy salvation;</i> | Remember me, LORD, when You show favor to Your people; come to my aid when You save them, |
| 5 | <i>That I may see the good of thy chosen, that I may rejoice in the gladness of thy nation, that I may glory with thine inheritance.</i> | that I may enjoy the prosperity of Your chosen ones, that I may share in the joy of Your nation and join Your inheritance in giving praise. |

- 6 *We have sinned with our fathers, we have committed iniquity, we have done wickedly.* We have sinned with our fathers; we have committed iniquity; we have done wickedly.
- 7 *Our fathers understood not thy wonders in Egypt; they remembered not the multitude of thy mercies; but provoked him at the sea, even at the Red sea.* Our fathers did not understand Your wonders in Egypt; they did not remember the multitude of Your mercies; but provoked Him at the sea, even at the Red Sea.
- 8 *Nevertheless he saved them for his name's sake, that he might make his mighty power to be known.* Yet He saved them for His name's sake, to make His mighty power known.
- 9 *He rebuked the Red sea also, and it was dried up: so he led them through the depths, as through the wilderness.* He rebuked the Red Sea. It dried up; He led them through the depths as through a desert.
- 10 *And he saved them from the hand of him that hated them, and redeemed them from the hand of the enemy.* He saved them from the hand of the foe; from the hand of the enemy he redeemed them.
- 11 *And the waters covered their enemies: there was not one of them left.* The waters covered their adversaries; not one of them survived.
- 12 *Then believed they his words; they sang his praise.* Then they believed His promises and sang His praise.
- 13 *They soon forgot his works; they waited not for his counsel:* But they soon forgot what He had done and did not wait for His plan to unfold.
- 14 *But lusted exceedingly in the wilderness, and tempted God in the desert.* In the desert they gave in to their craving; in the wilderness they put God to the test.
- 15 *And he gave them their request; but sent leanness into their soul.* So He gave them what they asked for, but sent a wasting disease among them.
- 16 *They envied Moses also in the camp, and Aaron the saint of the LORD.* In the camp they grew envious of Moses and of Aaron, who was consecrated to the LORD.
- 17 *The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan, and covered the company of Abiram.* The earth opened up and swallowed Dathan; it buried the company of Abiram.

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| 18 <i>And a fire was kindled in their company; the flame burned up the wicked.</i> | Fire blazed among their followers; a flame consumed the wicked. |
| 19 <i>They made a calf in Horeb, and worshipped the molten image.</i> | At Horeb they made a calf and worshiped an idol cast from metal. |
| 20 <i>Thus they changed their glory into the similitude of an ox that eateth grass.</i> | They exchanged their glorious God for an image of a bull, which eats grass. |
| 21 <i>They forgot God their saviour, which had done great things in Egypt;</i> | They forgot the God Who saved them, who had done great things in Egypt, |
| 22 <i>Wondrous works in the land of Ham, and terrible things by the Red sea.</i> | miracles in the land of Ham and awesome deeds by the Red Sea. |
| 23 <i>Therefore he said that he would destroy them, had not Moses his chosen stood before him in the breach, to turn away his wrath, lest he should destroy them.</i> | So he said he would destroy them — had not Moses, his chosen one, stood in the breach before him to keep his wrath from destroying them. |
| 24 <i>Yea, they despised the pleasant land, they believed not his word:</i> | Then they despised the pleasant land; they did not believe his promise. |
| 25 <i>But murmured in their tents, and hearkened not unto the voice of the LORD.</i> | They grumbled in their tents and did not obey the LORD. |
| 26 <i>Therefore he lifted up his hand against them, to overthrow them in the wilderness:</i> | So He swore to them with uplifted hand that He would make them fall in the wilderness, |
| 27 <i>To overthrow their seed also among the nations, and to scatter them in the lands.</i> | make their descendants fall among the nations and scatter them throughout the lands. |
| 28 <i>They joined themselves also unto Baalpeor, and ate the sacrifices of the dead.</i> | They yoked themselves to the Baal of Peor and ate sacrifices offered to lifeless gods; |
| 29 <i>Thus they provoked him to anger with their inventions: and the plague brake in upon them.</i> | they aroused the LORD's anger by their wicked deeds, and a plague broke out among them. |

- 30 *Then stood up Phinehas, and executed judgment: and so the plague was stayed.* But Phinehas stood up and intervened, and the plague was checked.
- 31 *And that was counted unto him for righteousness unto all generations for evermore.* This was credited to Him as righteousness for endless generations to come.
- 32 *They angered him also at the waters of strife, so that it went ill with Moses for their sakes:* By the waters of Meribah they angered the LORD, and trouble came to Moses because of them;
- 33 *Because they provoked his spirit, so that he spake unadvisedly with his lips.* for they rebelled against the Spirit of God, and rash words came from Moses' lips.
- 34 *They did not destroy the nations, concerning whom the LORD commanded them:* They did not destroy the peoples as the LORD had commanded them,
- 35 *But were mingled among the heathen, and learned their works.* but they mingled with the nations and adopted their customs.
- 36 *And they served their idols: which were a snare unto them.* They worshiped their idols, which became a snare to them.
- 37 *Yea, they sacrificed their sons and their daughters unto devils,* They sacrificed their sons and their daughters to false gods.
- 38 *And shed innocent blood, even the blood of their sons and of their daughters, whom they sacrificed unto the idols of Canaan: and the land was polluted with blood.* They shed innocent blood, the blood of their sons and daughters, whom they sacrificed to the idols of Canaan, and the land was desecrated by their blood.
- 39 *Thus were they defiled with their own works, and went a whoring with their own inventions.* They defiled themselves by what they did; by their deeds they prostituted themselves.
- 40 *Therefore was the wrath of the LORD kindled against his people, insomuch that he abhorred his own inheritance.* Therefore the LORD was angry with His people and abhorred His inheritance.

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| 41 <i>And he gave them into the hand of the heathen; and they that hated them ruled over them.</i> | He gave them into the hands of the nations. Their foes ruled over them. |
| 42 <i>Their enemies also oppressed them, and they were brought into subjection under their hand.</i> | Their enemies oppressed them and subjected them to their power. |
| 43 <i>Many times did he deliver them; but they provoked him with their counsel, and were brought low for their iniquity.</i> | Many times He delivered them, but they provoked Him with their counsel and were brought low for their iniquity. |
| 44 <i>Nevertheless he regarded their affliction, when he heard their cry:</i> | Yet He took note of their distress when He heard their cry; |
| 45 <i>And he remembered for them his covenant, and repented according to the multitude of his mercies.</i> | And He remembered for them His covenant, and relented according to the multitude of His mercies. |
| 46 <i>He made them also to be pitied of all those that carried them captives.</i> | He caused all who held them captive to show them mercy. |
| 47 <i>Save us, O LORD our God, and gather us from among the heathen, to give thanks unto thy holy name, and to triumph in thy praise.</i> | Save us, LORD our God, and gather us from the nations, that we may give thanks to your holy name and glory in Your praise. |
| 48 <i>Blessed be the LORD God of Israel from everlasting to everlasting: and let all the people say, Amen. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Let all the people say, "Amen!" Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Thess 5:18; 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 105:1; Ps 136:1; Jer 33:11

v4 — Ps 119:132; Luke 23:42; Neh 13:14; Neh 13:31; Ps 25:7

v8 — Ex 9:16; Ezek 20:9; Ezek 20:14; Jer 14:21; Ezek 20:44

v9 — Ps 18:15; Nah 1:4; Ps 78:13; Isa 63:11-14; Isa 51:10

v13 — Ps 78:11; Ex 15:24; Ex 16:2; Isa 48:17-18; Prov 1:25

v24 — Deut 1:32; Ezek 20:6; Num 14:31; Heb 3:18-19; Heb 4:6

v26 — Ezek 20:15; Num 14:28-35; Ps 95:11; Heb 3:11

v30 — Num 25:6-8; Josh 7:12; Num 25:14-15; 1 Kgs 18:40-41; Jonah 1:12-15

v32 — Num 20:2-13; Deut 4:21; Ps 81:7; Num 20:23-24; Deut 1:37

v34 — Deut 7:2; Deut 7:16; Judg 1:21

v37 — 2 Kgs 16:3; 2 Kgs 17:17; Deut 32:17; Jer 7:31

v45 — Ps 105:8; 2 Kgs 13:23; Lam 3:32; Judg 2:18; Ex 32:14

Psalm 107

The psalmist calls the redeemed to give thanks, recounting four portraits of human distress — wanderers in the desert, prisoners in darkness, fools near death, and sailors in a storm — each delivered by crying out to the LORD. The refrain repeats: let them praise the LORD for His mercy and His wonderful works for mankind.

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| 1 | <i>O give thanks unto the LORD, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; His mercy endures forever. |
| 2 | <i>Let the redeemed of the LORD say so, whom he hath redeemed from the hand of the enemy;</i> | Let the redeemed of the LORD tell their story — those He redeemed from the hand of the enemy, |
| 3 | <i>And gathered them out of the lands, from the east, and from the west, from the north, and from the south.</i> | those He gathered from the lands, from east and west, from north and south. |
| 4 | <i>They wandered in the wilderness in a solitary way; they found no city to dwell in.</i> | Some wandered in desert wastelands, finding no way to a city where they could settle. |
| 5 | <i>Hungry and thirsty, their soul fainted in them.</i> | They were hungry and thirsty, and their lives ebbed away. |
| 6 | <i>Then they cried unto the LORD in their trouble, and he delivered them out of their distresses.</i> | Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and He delivered them from their distress. |
| 7 | <i>And he led them forth by the right way, that they might go to a city of habitation.</i> | He led them by a straight way to a city where they could settle. |
| 8 | <i>Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!</i> | Let them give thanks to the LORD for His mercy and His wonderful works for mankind, |

- 9 *For he satisfieth the longing soul, and filleth the hungry soul with goodness.* for He satisfies the thirsty and fills the hungry with good things.
- 10 *Such as sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, being bound in affliction and iron;* Some sat in darkness and deep shadow, prisoners suffering in iron chains,
- 11 *Because they rebelled against the words of God, and contemned the counsel of the most High:* because they had rebelled against God's commands and despised the counsel of the Most High.
- 12 *Therefore he brought down their heart with labour; they fell down, and there was none to help.* So He subjected them to bitter labor; they stumbled and there was no one to help.
- 13 *Then they cried unto the LORD in their trouble, and he saved them out of their distresses.* Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and He saved them from their distress.
- 14 *He brought them out of darkness and the shadow of death, and brake their bands in sunder.* He brought them out of darkness and deep shadow and broke away their chains.
- 15 *Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!* Let them give thanks to the LORD for His mercy and His wonderful works for mankind,
- 16 *For he hath broken the gates of brass, and cut the bars of iron in sunder.* for He breaks down gates of bronze and cuts through bars of iron.
- 17 *Fools because of their transgression, and because of their iniquities, are afflicted.* Some became fools through their rebellious ways and suffered affliction because of their iniquities.
- 18 *Their soul abhorreth all manner of meat; and they draw near unto the gates of death.* They loathed all food and drew near to the gates of death.
- 19 *Then they cry unto the LORD in their trouble, and he saveth them out of their distresses.* Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and He saved them from their distress.

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| 20 <i>He sent his word, and healed them,
and delivered them from their
destructions.</i> | He sent out His word and healed them;
He rescued them from the grave. |
| 21 <i>Oh that men would praise the LORD
for his goodness, and for his
wonderful works to the children of
men!</i> | Let them give thanks to the LORD for
His mercy and His wonderful works
for mankind. |
| 22 <i>And let them sacrifice the sacrifices of
thanksgiving, and declare his works
with rejoicing.</i> | Let them offer sacrifices of
thanksgiving and tell of His works
with songs of joy. |
| 23 <i>They that go down to the sea in ships,
that do business in great waters;</i> | Some went out on the sea in ships; they
were merchants on the mighty waters. |
| 24 <i>These see the works of the LORD, and
his wonders in the deep.</i> | They saw the works of the LORD, His
wonderful deeds in the deep. |
| 25 <i>For he commandeth, and raiseth the
stormy wind, which lifteth up the
waves thereof.</i> | For He spoke and stirred up a tempest
that lifted high the waves. |
| 26 <i>They mount up to the heaven, they go
down again to the depths: their soul is
melted because of trouble.</i> | They mounted up to the heavens and
went down to the depths; in their peril
their courage melted away. |
| 27 <i>They reel to and fro, and stagger like
a drunken man, and are at their wits'
end.</i> | They reeled and staggered like
drunkards; they were at their wits' end. |
| 28 <i>Then they cry unto the LORD in their
trouble, and he bringeth them out of
their distresses.</i> | Then they cried to the LORD in their
trouble, and He brought them out of
their distress. |
| 29 <i>He maketh the storm a calm, so that
the waves thereof are still.</i> | He stilled the storm to a whisper; the
waves of the sea were hushed. |
| 30 <i>Then are they glad because they be
quiet; so he bringeth them unto their
desired haven.</i> | They were glad when it grew calm,
and He guided them to their desired
haven. |

- 31 *Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!* Let them give thanks to the LORD for His mercy and His wonderful works for mankind.
- 32 *Let them exalt him also in the congregation of the people, and praise him in the assembly of the elders.* Let them exalt Him in the assembly of the people and praise him in the council of the elders.
- 33 *He turneth rivers into a wilderness, and the watersprings into dry ground;* He turns rivers into a desert, flowing springs into thirsty ground,
- 34 *A fruitful land into barrenness, for the wickedness of them that dwell therein.* and fruitful land into a salt waste, because of the wickedness of those who live there.
- 35 *He turneth the wilderness into a standing water, and dry ground into watersprings.* He turns the desert into pools of water and the parched ground into flowing springs;
- 36 *And there he maketh the hungry to dwell, that they may prepare a city for habitation;* there He brings the hungry to live, and they found a city where they could settle.
- 37 *And sow the fields, and plant vineyards, which may yield fruits of increase.* They sow fields and plant vineyards that yield a fruitful harvest.
- 38 *He blesseth them also, so that they are multiplied greatly; and suffereth not their cattle to decrease.* He blesses them and their numbers grow greatly, and He does not let their herds diminish.
- 39 *Again, they are minished and brought low through oppression, affliction, and sorrow.* Then their numbers decreased and they were humbled by oppression, calamity, and sorrow;
- 40 *He poureth contempt upon princes, and causeth them to wander in the wilderness, where there is no way.* he who pours contempt on nobles made them wander in a trackless waste.
- 41 *Yet setteth he the poor on high from affliction, and maketh him families like a flock.* But He lifted the needy out of their affliction and made their families like flocks of sheep.

- 42

The righteous shall see it, and rejoice: and all iniquity shall stop her mouth.

The upright see and rejoice, while all the wicked shut their mouths.
- 43

Whoso is wise, and will observe these things, even they shall understand the lovingkindness of the LORD.

Whoever is wise, and will observe these things, even they shall understand the lovingkindness of the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 106:1; 2 Chr 7:3; Ps 105:1; Ps 100:5
- v2 — 1 Pet 1:18-19; Luke 1:74; Gal 3:13; Ps 106:10; Ps 31:5
- v6 — Ps 50:15; Ps 91:15; Jer 29:12-14; Heb 4:15-16; Ps 107:19
- v8 — Ps 147:1; Ps 107:31; Dan 4:2-3; Ps 107:21; Dan 6:27
- v9 — Matt 5:6; Jer 31:25; Ps 34:10; Luke 1:53; Ps 146:7
- v13 — Ps 107:28; Ps 107:6; Judg 6:6-10; Judg 4:3; 2 Chr 33:12-13
- v14 — Isa 42:16; Ps 116:16; Eph 5:8; Zech 9:11-12; 1 Pet 2:9
- v20 — Matt 8:8; Ps 103:3-4; Ps 147:15; Ps 147:3; 2 Kgs 20:4-5
- v25 — Jonah 1:4; Matt 8:24; Ps 148:8; Ps 93:3; Ps 105:34
- v29 — Matt 8:26; Ps 65:7; Luke 8:23-25; Ps 89:9; Mark 4:39-41
- v35 — Ps 114:8; Isa 35:6-7; Isa 41:17-19; Isa 44:3-5
- v38 — Ex 1:7; Gen 12:2; Gen 17:20; Ps 128:1-6; Deut 30:9

Psalm 108

A Song or Psalm of David.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **David** (DAY-vid) — "beloved" — The shepherd-king of Israel, youngest son of Jesse, anointed by Samuel, slayer of Goliath, and Israel's greatest king. God made an everlasting covenant with David that his throne would endure forever — fulfilled in Jesus Christ, "the son of David" (Matt 1:1). David is credited with writing roughly half the Psalms.

David praises God with a fixed heart, declaring God's mercy above the heavens and His sovereignty over all the lands of Israel and its neighbors. He asks God for help in battle, knowing that with God they will gain the victory, for the help of man is worthless.

- 1

O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise, even with my glory.

O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise, even with my glory.
- 2

Awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.

Awake, harp and lyre! I will awaken the dawn.

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| <p>3 <i>I will praise thee, O LORD, among the people: and I will sing praises unto thee among the nations.</i></p> <p>4 <i>For thy mercy is great above the heavens: and thy truth reacheth unto the clouds.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: and thy glory above all the earth;</i></p> <p>6 <i>That thy beloved may be delivered: save with thy right hand, and answer me.</i></p> <p>7 <i>God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Gilead is mine; Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;</i></p> <p>9 <i>Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe; over Philistia will I triumph.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?</i></p> <p>11 <i>Wilt not thou, O God, who hast cast us off? and wilt not thou, O God, go forth with our hosts?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.</i></p> | <p>I will praise You, LORD, among the nations; I will sing of you among the peoples.</p> <p>For Your mercy is great above the heavens, and Your truth reaches to the clouds.</p> <p>Be exalted, O God, above the heavens; let Your glory be over all the earth.</p> <p>Save us and help us with Your right hand, that those You love may be delivered.</p> <p>God has spoken in His holiness: "I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and measure out the valley of Succoth.</p> <p>Gilead is mine, Manasseh is mine; Ephraim is my helmet, Judah is my scepter.</p> <p>Moab is my washbasin, on Edom I toss my sandal; over Philistia I shout in triumph."</p> <p>Who will bring me to the fortified city? Who will lead me to Edom?</p> <p>Is it not You, God, You who have now rejected us and no longer go out with our armies?</p> <p>Give us help from trouble, for vain is the help of man.</p> <p>With God we will gain the victory, and He will trample down our enemies.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 57:7-11; Ps 145:21-146:2; Ps 71:15; Ps 104:33; Ps 71:23-24
- v2 — Ps 69:30; Ps 81:2; Ps 33:2; Ps 57:8
- v3 — Ps 22:27; Ps 22:22; Ps 117:1; Zeph 3:14
- v4 — Ps 36:5
- v5 — Ps 57:5; Matt 6:9-10; Ps 148:13
- v6 — Ps 60:5-12; 2 Chr 32:20-22; Col 3:12; Deut 33:12; Ps 35:1-3
- v11 — 2 Chr 13:12
- v12 — Jer 17:5-8
- v13 — Ps 118:6-13; Rom 16:20; Ps 60:12

Psalm 109

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

David cries out against enemies who repay his love with hatred and his friendship with lies, calling down detailed curses on the one who persecuted the poor and brokenhearted. He then turns to God for deliverance, declaring his own poverty and trusting that the LORD stands at the right hand of the needy.

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| 1 | <i>Hold not thy peace, O God of my praise;</i> | O God, whom I praise, do not remain silent, |
| 2 | <i>For the mouth of the wicked and the mouth of the deceitful are opened against me: they have spoken against me with a lying tongue.</i> | for wicked and deceitful mouths have opened against me; they have spoken to me with lying tongues. |
| 3 | <i>They compassed me about also with words of hatred; and fought against me without a cause.</i> | With words of hatred they surround me; they attack me without cause. |
| 4 | <i>For my love they are my adversaries: but I give myself unto prayer.</i> | In return for my friendship they accuse me, but I am a man of prayer. |
| 5 | <i>And they have rewarded me evil for good, and hatred for my love.</i> | They repay me evil for good, and hatred for my friendship. |
| 6 | <i>Set thou a wicked man over him: and let Satan stand at his right hand.</i> | Appoint someone evil to oppose my enemy; let an accuser stand at His right hand. |
| 7 | <i>When he shall be judged, let him be condemned: and let his prayer become sin.</i> | When He is tried, let Him be found guilty, and may His prayers condemn Him. |

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| 8 | <i>Let his days be few; and let another take his office.</i> | May His days be few; may another take His place of leadership. |
| 9 | <i>Let his children be fatherless, and his wife a widow.</i> | May His children be fatherless and his wife a widow. |
| 10 | <i>Let his children be continually vagabonds, and beg; let them seek their bread also out of their desolate places.</i> | May His children wander about and beg; may they be driven from their ruined homes. |
| 11 | <i>Let the extortioner catch all that he hath; and let the strangers spoil his labour.</i> | May a creditor seize all He has; may strangers plunder the fruits of His labor. |
| 12 | <i>Let there be none to extend mercy unto him: neither let there be any to favour his fatherless children.</i> | May no one extend kindness to him or take pity on his fatherless children. |
| 13 | <i>Let his posterity be cut off; and in the generation following let their name be blotted out.</i> | May His descendants be cut off, their names blotted out from the next generation. |
| 14 | <i>Let the iniquity of his fathers be remembered with the LORD; and let not the sin of his mother be blotted out.</i> | May the iniquity of His fathers be remembered before the LORD; may the sin of His mother never be blotted out. |
| 15 | <i>Let them be before the LORD continually, that he may cut off the memory of them from the earth.</i> | May their sins always remain before the LORD, that He may blot out their name from the earth. |
| 16 | <i>Because that he remembered not to shew mercy, but persecuted the poor and needy man, that he might even slay the broken in heart.</i> | For He never thought of doing a kindness, but hounded to death the poor, the needy, and the brokenhearted. |
| 17 | <i>As he loved cursing, so let it come unto him: as he delighted not in blessing, so let it be far from him.</i> | He loved to curse — may it come back on Him. He found no pleasure in blessing — may it be far from Him. |

- 18 *As he clothed himself with cursing like as with his garment, so let it come into his bowels like water, and like oil into his bones.* He wore cursing as His garment; it entered His body like water, like oil into His bones.
- 19 *Let it be unto him as the garment which covereth him, and for a girdle wherewith he is girded continually.* May it be like a cloak wrapped about Him, like a belt tied forever around Him.
- 20 *Let this be the reward of mine adversaries from the LORD, and of them that speak evil against my soul.* May this be the LORD's payment to my accusers, to those who speak evil against me.
- 21 *But do thou for me, O GOD the Lord, for thy name's sake: because thy mercy is good, deliver thou me.* But do for me, O GOD the Lord, for Your name's sake; because Your mercy is good, deliver me.
- 22 *For I am poor and needy, and my heart is wounded within me.* For I am poor and needy, and my heart is wounded within me.
- 23 *I am gone like the shadow when it declineth; I am tossed up and down as the locust.* I fade away like an evening shadow; I am shaken off like a locust.
- 24 *My knees are weak through fasting; and my flesh faileth of fatness.* My knees give way from fasting; my body is thin and gaunt.
- 25 *I became also a reproach unto them: when they looked upon me they shook their head.* I am an object of scorn to my accusers; when they see me, they shake their heads.
- 26 *Help me, O LORD my God: O save me according to thy mercy:* Help me, LORD my God; save me according to Your mercy.
- 27 *That they may know that this is thy hand; that thou, LORD, hast done it.* Let them know that it is Your hand, that You, LORD, have done it.
- 28 *Let them curse, but bless thou: when they arise, let them be ashamed; but let thy servant rejoice.* While they curse, may You bless; may those who attack me be put to shame, but may Your servant rejoice.
- 29 *Let mine adversaries be clothed with shame, and let them cover themselves with their own confusion, as with a mantle.* May my accusers be clothed with disgrace and wrapped in shame as in a cloak.

- 30

I will greatly praise the LORD with my mouth; yea, I will praise him among the multitude.

With my mouth I will greatly praise the LORD; in the midst of the crowd I will praise Him.
- 31

For he shall stand at the right hand of the poor, to save him from those that condemn his soul.

For He stands at the right hand of the needy, to save their lives from those who would condemn them.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 28:1; Ps 83:1; Deut 10:21
- v2 — Ps 52:4; Prov 6:17; Ps 120:2-3
- v4 — Ps 38:20; Ps 69:12-13; Luke 23:34; Ps 35:7; Ps 55:16-17
- v7 — Prov 28:9; Prov 21:27; Gal 3:10; Prov 15:8
- v13 — Prov 10:7; Ps 37:28; Job 18:19
- v14 — Ex 20:5; Neh 4:5; Jer 18:23
- v15 — Ps 34:16; Ps 90:8; Job 18:17
- v17 — Matt 7:2; Prov 14:14; Ps 59:12-13; Ps 52:4-5; Ezek 35:6
- v21 — Ps 69:16; Ps 31:3; Ps 79:9-10; Ps 63:3; Ps 25:11
- v27 — Job 37:7; 1 Kgs 18:36-37; Ex 8:19; Ps 64:8-9; Ps 17:13-14
- v29 — Ps 35:26; Ps 132:18; Job 8:22
- v31 — Ps 121:5; Ps 16:8; Ps 110:5; Ps 73:23; Isa 54:17

Psalm 110

A Psalm of David.

The LORD speaks to David's Lord, commanding Him to sit at His right hand until His enemies are made His footstool, and swearing an irrevocable oath that He is a priest forever after the order of Melchizedek. This is the most-quoted psalm in the New Testament, pointing directly to Christ as both King and eternal Priest.

- 1

The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou at my right hand, until I make thine enemies thy footstool.

The LORD says to my lord: "Sit at my right hand until I make Your enemies a footstool for Your feet."
- 2

The LORD shall send the rod of thy strength out of Zion: rule thou in the midst of thine enemies.

The LORD will extend Your mighty scepter from Zion, saying, "Rule in the midst of Your enemies!"

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| 3 <i>Thy people shall be willing in the day of thy power, in the beauties of holiness from the womb of the morning: thou hast the dew of thy youth.</i> | Your troops will be willing on Your day of battle. Arrayed in holy splendor, Your young men will come to You like dew from the morning's womb. |
| 4 <i>The LORD hath sworn, and will not repent, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchizedek.</i> | The LORD has sworn and will not change His mind: "You are a priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek." |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Melchizedek** (mel-KIZ-eh-dek) — "king of righteousness" — The mysterious king of Salem and priest of the Most High God who blessed Abraham (Gen 14:18–20). He appears without genealogy, without record of birth or death, and is used in Hebrews 5–7 as a type of Christ — who is both King and Priest forever.

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| 5 <i>The Lord at thy right hand shall strike through kings in the day of his wrath.</i> | The Lord is at Your right hand; He will crush kings on the day of His wrath. |
| 6 <i>He shall judge among the heathen, he shall fill the places with the dead bodies; he shall wound the heads over many countries.</i> | He will judge the nations, heaping up the dead and crushing the rulers of the whole earth. |
| 7 <i>He shall drink of the brook in the way: therefore shall he lift up the head.</i> | He will drink from a brook along the way, and so He will lift His head high. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 10:12-13; 1 Cor 15:25; Luke 20:42-43; Heb 1:13; Mark 12:35-37
- v3 — Judg 5:2; Heb 13:21; Titus 2:14; 1 Thess 4:7; Eph 1:4
- v4 — Heb 7:17; Heb 5:6; Heb 7:21; Gen 14:18; Heb 7:28
- v5 — Rom 2:5; Ps 16:8; Rev 6:15-17; Rev 17:12-14
- v6 — Ps 68:21
- v7 — Ps 27:6

Psalm 111

The psalmist praises the LORD with his whole heart, declaring that God's works are great, His righteousness endures forever, and He has sent redemption to His people. The psalm closes with the foundational declaration that the fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.

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| 1 | <i>Praise ye the LORD. I will praise the LORD with my whole heart, in the assembly of the upright, and in the congregation.</i> | Praise the LORD. I will extol the LORD with all my heart in the council of the upright and in the assembly. |
| 2 | <i>The works of the LORD are great, sought out of all them that have pleasure therein.</i> | Great are the works of the LORD; they are pondered by all who delight in them. |
| 3 | <i>His work is honourable and glorious: and his righteousness endureth for ever.</i> | Glorious and majestic are His deeds, and His righteousness endures forever. |
| 4 | <i>He hath made his wonderful works to be remembered: the LORD is gracious and full of compassion.</i> | He has caused His wonders to be remembered; the LORD is gracious and compassionate. |
| 5 | <i>He hath given meat unto them that fear him: he will ever be mindful of his covenant.</i> | He provides food for those who fear Him; He remembers His covenant forever. |
| 6 | <i>He hath shewed his people the power of his works, that he may give them the heritage of the heathen.</i> | He has shown His people the power of His works, giving them the lands of other nations. |
| 7 | <i>The works of his hands are verity and judgment; all his commandments are sure.</i> | The works of His hands are faithful and just; all His precepts are trustworthy. |
| 8 | <i>They stand fast for ever and ever, and are done in truth and uprightness.</i> | They are established for ever and ever, enacted in faithfulness and uprightness. |
| 9 | <i>He sent redemption unto his people: he hath commanded his covenant for ever: holy and reverend is his name.</i> | He provided redemption for His people; He ordained His covenant forever — holy and awesome is His name. |
| 10 | <i>The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom: a good understanding have all they that do his commandments: his praise endureth for ever.</i> | The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom; all who follow His precepts have good understanding. His praise endures forever. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 138:1; Ps 149:1; Ps 106:1; Ps 35:18; Ps 109:30
- v2 — Ps 104:24; Prov 24:14; Ps 139:14; Ps 143:5; Eph 1:19
- v3 — Ps 145:4-5; Ps 145:10-12; Eph 3:10; Rev 5:12-14
- v4 — Ps 103:8; Isa 63:7; Eph 1:6-8; Ps 86:5; Ps 145:8
- v5 — Ps 105:8
- v6 — Ps 80:8; Ps 2:8; Josh 10:13-14; Ps 44:2; Josh 6:20
- v7 — Ps 19:7; Ps 89:14
- v8 — Matt 5:18; Ps 19:9
- v9 — Ps 99:3; Titus 2:14; Luke 1:68; Luke 1:49; Rev 5:9
- v10 — Prov 1:7; Prov 9:10; Job 28:28; Eccl 12:13; Deut 4:6

Psalm 112

The psalmist describes the blessings of the one who fears the LORD and delights in His commands — prosperity, generosity, a secure heart, and triumph over enemies. The wicked see it and are vexed, but the righteousness of the godly endures forever.

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| 1 <i>Praise ye the LORD. Blessed is the man that feareth the LORD, that delighteth greatly in his commandments.</i> | Praise the LORD. Blessed are those who fear the LORD, Who find great delight in His commands. |
| 2 <i>His seed shall be mighty upon earth: the generation of the upright shall be blessed.</i> | Their children will be mighty in the land; the generation of the upright will be blessed. |
| 3 <i>Wealth and riches shall be in his house: and his righteousness endureth for ever.</i> | Wealth and riches are in their houses, and their righteousness endures forever. |
| 4 <i>Unto the upright there ariseth light in the darkness: he is gracious, and full of compassion, and righteous.</i> | Even in darkness light dawns for the upright, for those who are gracious and compassionate and righteous. |
| 5 <i>A good man sheweth favour, and lendeth: he will guide his affairs with discretion.</i> | Good will come to those who are generous and lend freely, who conduct their affairs with justice. |
| 6 <i>Surely he shall not be moved for ever: the righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance.</i> | Surely the righteous will never be shaken; they will be remembered forever. |

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| 7 | <i>He shall not be afraid of evil tidings:
his heart is fixed, trusting in the
LORD.</i> | He shall not be afraid of evil tidings;
His heart is fixed, trusting in the
LORD. |
| 8 | <i>His heart is established, he shall not
be afraid, until he see his desire upon
his enemies.</i> | Their hearts are secure, they will have
no fear; in the end they will look in
triumph on their foes. |
| 9 | <i>He hath dispersed, he hath given to
the poor; his righteousness endureth
for ever; his horn shall be exalted
with honour.</i> | They have freely scattered their gifts to
the poor; their righteousness endures
forever; their horn will be lifted high in
honor. |
| 10 | <i>The wicked shall see it, and be
grieved; he shall gnash with his teeth,
and melt away: the desire of the
wicked shall perish.</i> | The wicked will see and be vexed; they
will gnash their teeth and waste away;
the longings of the wicked will come
to nothing. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 128:1; Luke 1:50; Isa 50:10; Ps 119:47-48; Ps 119:35
v2 — Gen 17:7; Prov 20:7; Ps 37:26; Acts 2:39; Ps 25:13
v3 — Prov 15:6; Prov 3:16; Matt 6:33; Isa 33:6; Phil 4:18-19
v4 — Job 11:17; Ps 97:11; Col 3:12-13; Isa 58:10; 1 John 3:7
v5 — Ps 37:21; Prov 2:20; Eph 5:15; Phil 1:9; John 6:12
v6 — Prov 10:7; Heb 6:10; Ps 125:1; Ps 62:2; Ps 15:5
v7 — Isa 26:3-4; Prov 1:33; Ps 57:7; Ps 118:6; John 14:1
v8 — Ps 91:8; Ps 118:7; Ps 31:24; Ps 59:10
v9 — Heb 13:16; Ps 75:10; 2 Cor 9:9-15; Jas 2:15-16; 1 Tim 6:18
v10 — Prov 10:28; Ps 58:7-8; Prov 11:7; Luke 13:28; Ps 37:12

Psalm 113

The psalmist calls the servants of the LORD to praise His name from the rising of the sun to its setting, exalting God who sits enthroned on high yet stoops down to regard heaven and earth. He raises the poor from the dust and the needy from the ash heap, seating them with princes and giving the barren woman a home as a joyful mother.

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| 1 | <i>Praise ye the LORD. Praise, O ye
servants of the LORD, praise the
name of the LORD.</i> | Praise the LORD. Praise the LORD,
You His servants; praise the name of
the LORD. |
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| <p>2 <i>Blessed be the name of the LORD
from this time forth and for evermore.</i></p> <p>3 <i>From the rising of the sun unto the
going down of the same the LORD'S
name is to be praised.</i></p> <p>4 <i>The LORD is high above all nations,
and his glory above the heavens.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Who is like unto the LORD our God,
who dwelleth on high,</i></p> <p>6 <i>Who humbleth himself to behold the
things that are in heaven, and in the
earth!</i></p> <p>7 <i>He raiseth up the poor out of the dust,
and lifteth the needy out of the
dunghill;</i></p> <p>8 <i>That he may set him with princes,
even with the princes of his people.</i></p> <p>9 <i>He maketh the barren woman to keep
house, and to be a joyful mother of
children. Praise ye the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Let the name of the LORD be praised,
both now and forevermore.</p> <p>From the rising of the sun to the place
where it sets, the name of the LORD is
to be praised.</p> <p>The LORD is exalted over all the
nations, his glory above the heavens.</p> <p>Who is like the LORD our God, the
One who sits enthroned on high,
who stoops down to look on the
heavens and the earth?</p> <p>He raises the poor from the dust and
lifts the needy from the ash heap;</p> <p>he seats them with princes, with the
princes of His people.</p> <p>He settles the childless woman in her
home as a happy mother of children.
Praise the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eph 5:19-20; Ps 135:1-3
- v2 — Dan 2:20
- v3 — Mal 1:11; Ps 18:3; Isa 59:19; Isa 49:13; Ps 86:9
- v4 — Ps 8:1; Ps 99:2; Ps 97:9; Ps 148:13; Isa 40:17
- v5 — Ps 89:6; Jer 10:6; Isa 40:25; Deut 33:26; Ex 15:11
- v6 — Isa 57:15; Ps 11:4; Ps 138:6
- v7 — 1 Sam 2:7-8; Luke 1:52-53; Ps 107:41; Job 5:11; 2 Sam 7:8-9
- v8 — Job 36:7; Phil 2:8-11
- v9 — Ps 68:6; 1 Sam 2:5; Gen 21:5-7; Gen 30:22-23; Isa 54:1

Psalm 114

The psalmist celebrates the exodus in vivid poetic imagery: the sea fled, the Jordan turned back, the mountains skipped like rams, and the hills like lambs. All creation trembles at the presence of the God of Jacob, who turns rock into pools of water.

1	<i>When Israel went out of Egypt, the house of Jacob from a people of strange language;</i>	When Israel came out of Egypt, Jacob from a people of foreign tongue,
2	<i>Judah was his sanctuary, and Israel his dominion.</i>	Judah became God's sanctuary, Israel His domain.
3	<i>The sea saw it, and fled: Jordan was driven back.</i>	The sea looked and fled, the Jordan turned back;
4	<i>The mountains skipped like rams, and the little hills like lambs.</i>	the mountains leaped like rams, the hills like lambs.
5	<i>What ailed thee, O thou sea, that thou fleddest? thou Jordan, that thou wast driven back?</i>	Why was it, sea, that you fled? Why, Jordan, did you turn back?
6	<i>Ye mountains, that ye skipped like rams; and ye little hills, like lambs?</i>	Why, mountains, did you leap like rams, you hills, like lambs?
7	<i>Tremble, thou earth, at the presence of the Lord, at the presence of the God of Jacob;</i>	Tremble, earth, at the presence of the Lord, at the presence of the God of Jacob,
8	<i>Which turned the rock into a standing water, the flint into a fountain of waters.</i>	who turned the rock into a pool, the hard rock into springs of water.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 12:41-42; Ex 13:3; Ps 81:5; Gen 42:23; Deut 16:1
- v2 — Ex 25:8; Ex 15:17
- v3 — Ex 14:21; Ps 77:16; Hab 3:8-9; Josh 3:13-16; Isa 63:12
- v4 — Judg 5:4-5; Ex 19:18; Ex 20:18; Hab 3:6; Jer 4:23-24
- v5 — Hab 3:8
- v7 — Jer 5:22; Job 26:11; Isa 64:1-3; Ps 104:32; Ps 96:9
- v8 — Ps 107:35; Deut 8:15; Num 20:11; Ex 17:6; Ps 105:41

Psalm 115

The psalmist contrasts the living God in heaven, who does whatever He pleases, with the lifeless idols of the nations — silver and gold that cannot see, hear, or speak. He calls Israel, the house of Aaron, and all who fear the LORD to trust in Him as their help and shield.

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| 1 <i>Not unto us, O LORD, not unto us, but unto thy name give glory, for thy mercy, and for thy truth's sake.</i> | Not to us, O LORD, not to us, but to Your name give glory, for Your mercy, and for Your truth's sake. |
| 2 <i>Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is now their God?</i> | Why do the nations say, "Where is their God?" |
| 3 <i>But our God is in the heavens: he hath done whatsoever he hath pleased.</i> | Our God is in heaven; He does whatever pleases Him. |
| 4 <i>Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.</i> | Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands. |
| 5 <i>They have mouths, but they speak not: eyes have they, but they see not:</i> | They have mouths, but cannot speak; eyes, but cannot see. |
| 6 <i>They have ears, but they hear not: noses have they, but they smell not:</i> | They have ears, but cannot hear; noses, but cannot smell. |
| 7 <i>They have hands, but they handle not: feet have they, but they walk not: neither speak they through their throat.</i> | They have hands, but cannot feel; feet, but cannot walk; nor can they utter a sound with their throats. |
| 8 <i>They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.</i> | Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them. |
| 9 <i>O Israel, trust thou in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.</i> | All You Israelites, trust in the LORD — He is their help and shield. |
| 10 <i>O house of Aaron, trust in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.</i> | House of Aaron, trust in the LORD — He is their help and shield. |
| 11 <i>Ye that fear the LORD, trust in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.</i> | You who fear Him, trust in the LORD — He is their help and shield. |
| 12 <i>The LORD hath been mindful of us: he will bless us; he will bless the house of Israel; he will bless the house of Aaron.</i> | The LORD remembers us and will bless us: He will bless His people Israel, He will bless the house of Aaron, |

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| 13 <i>He will bless them that fear the LORD, both small and great.</i> | he will bless those who fear the LORD — small and great alike. |
| 14 <i>The LORD shall increase you more and more, you and your children.</i> | May the LORD cause You to flourish, both You and Your children. |
| 15 <i>Ye are blessed of the LORD which made heaven and earth.</i> | May You be blessed by the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth. |
| 16 <i>The heaven, even the heavens, are the LORD'S: but the earth hath he given to the children of men.</i> | The highest heavens belong to the LORD, but the earth He has given to mankind. |
| 17 <i>The dead praise not the LORD, neither any that go down into silence.</i> | It is not the dead who praise the LORD, those who go down to the place of silence; |
| 18 <i>But we will bless the LORD from this time forth and for evermore. Praise the LORD.</i> | it is we who extol the LORD, both now and forevermore. Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 79:9-10; Isa 48:11; Ps 96:8; Ezek 20:14; Ezek 36:32
v3 — Ps 135:6; Dan 4:35; Isa 46:10; Eph 1:11; Ps 103:19
v4 — Deut 4:28; Isa 46:6-7; Jer 10:3-5; Isa 40:19-20; Hab 2:18-20
v8 — Ps 135:18; Jer 10:8; Hab 2:18-19; Jonah 2:8
v9 — Ps 62:8; Ps 37:3; Prov 30:5; Ps 118:2-4
v11 — Prov 14:26; Acts 10:35; Prov 30:5; Ps 147:11; Rev 19:5
v12 — Ps 136:23; Eph 1:3; Isa 44:21; Isa 49:14-16; Gen 12:2-3
v13 — Ps 112:1; Ps 128:1; Luke 1:50; Ps 128:4-5; Ps 29:11
v14 — Deut 1:11; Acts 2:39; Acts 3:25; Jer 33:22; Gen 17:7
v15 — Ps 134:3; Rev 14:7; Gen 14:19; Gen 1:1; Ps 121:2
v16 — Ps 8:6; Ps 89:11; Gen 1:28-30; Jer 27:5-6; Gen 9:1-3
v17 — Ps 6:5; Isa 38:18-19; Ps 88:10-12; Ps 30:9; Ps 31:17

Psalm 116

The psalmist declares his love for the LORD who heard his cry when the cords of death entangled him and delivered his soul from death, his eyes from tears, and his feet from stumbling. He asks what he can render to the LORD for all His benefits, and answers by lifting the cup of salvation and paying his vows in the presence of all God's people.

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| 1 | <i>I love the LORD, because he hath heard my voice and my supplications.</i> | I love the LORD, for He heard my voice; He heard my cry for mercy. |
| 2 | <i>Because he hath inclined his ear unto me, therefore will I call upon him as long as I live.</i> | Because He turned His ear to me, I will call on Him as long as I live. |
| 3 | <i>The sorrows of death compassed me, and the pains of hell gat hold upon me: I found trouble and sorrow.</i> | The cords of death entangled me, the anguish of hell came over me; I was overcome by distress and sorrow. |
| 4 | <i>Then called I upon the name of the LORD; O LORD, I beseech thee, deliver my soul.</i> | Then I called on the name of the LORD: "LORD, save me!" |
| 5 | <i>Gracious is the LORD, and righteous; yea, our God is merciful.</i> | The LORD is gracious and righteous; our God is full of compassion. |
| 6 | <i>The LORD preserveth the simple: I was brought low, and he helped me.</i> | The LORD protects the unwary; when I was brought low, He saved me. |
| 7 | <i>Return unto thy rest, O my soul; for the LORD hath dealt bountifully with thee.</i> | Return to Your rest, my soul, for the LORD has been good to You. |
| 8 | <i>For thou hast delivered my soul from death, mine eyes from tears, and my feet from falling.</i> | For You, LORD, have delivered me from death, my eyes from tears, my feet from stumbling, |
| 9 | <i>I will walk before the LORD in the land of the living.</i> | that I may walk before the LORD in the land of the living. |
| 10 | <i>I believed, therefore have I spoken: I was greatly afflicted:</i> | I trusted in the LORD when I said, "I am greatly afflicted"; |
| 11 | <i>I said in my haste, All men are liars.</i> | in my alarm I said, "Everyone is a liar." |
| 12 | <i>What shall I render unto the LORD for all his benefits toward me?</i> | What shall I return to the LORD for all His goodness to me? |
| 13 | <i>I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the name of the LORD.</i> | I will lift up the cup of salvation and call on the name of the LORD. |
| 14 | <i>I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people.</i> | I will fulfill my vows to the LORD in the presence of all His people. |

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| 15 <i>Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.</i> | Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of His faithful servants. |
| 16 <i>O LORD, truly I am thy servant; I am thy servant, and the son of thine handmaid: thou hast loosed my bonds.</i> | Truly I am Your servant, LORD; I serve You just as my mother did; You have freed me from my chains. |
| 17 <i>I will offer to thee the sacrifice of thanksgiving, and will call upon the name of the LORD.</i> | I will sacrifice a thank offering to You and call on the name of the LORD. |
| 18 <i>I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people,</i> | I will fulfill my vows to the LORD in the presence of all His people, |
| 19 <i>In the courts of the LORD'S house, in the midst of thee, O Jerusalem. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | in the courts of the house of the LORD — in Your midst, Jerusalem. Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 John 4:19; Ps 66:19-20; 1 John 5:2-3; Ps 34:3-4; John 16:24
v2 — Ps 145:18-19; Ps 40:1; Ps 55:16-17; Phil 4:6; Ps 86:6-7
v3 — Ps 18:4-6; Ps 38:6; Ps 88:6-7; Ps 32:3-4; Luke 22:44
v6 — Matt 11:25; Ps 142:6; Ps 19:7; Ps 79:8; Ps 25:21
v7 — Ps 13:6; Matt 11:28-29; Jer 6:16; Ps 119:17; Jer 30:10
v8 — Ps 56:13; Rev 21:4; Ps 86:13; Rev 7:17; Isa 25:8
v10 — 2 Cor 4:13; Heb 11:1; Prov 21:28; 2 Pet 1:21; 2 Pet 1:16
v11 — Jer 9:4-5; Rom 3:4; Ps 31:22; Ps 62:9; 1 Sam 27:1
v12 — Ps 103:2; 1 Cor 6:20; 2 Cor 5:14-15; Rom 12:1; 2 Chr 32:25
v13 — Ps 16:5; Ps 116:2; Ps 105:1; Ps 80:18; 1 Cor 10:21
v15 — Ps 72:14; 1 Sam 25:29; Ps 37:32-33; Rev 14:3; Luke 16:22
v16 — Ps 86:16; Ps 143:12; Ps 119:125

Psalm 117

The shortest chapter in the Bible calls all nations and all peoples to praise the LORD, for His mercy toward us is great and His truth endures forever.

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| 1 <i>O praise the LORD, all ye nations: praise him, all ye people.</i> | Praise the LORD, all You nations; extol Him, all you peoples. |
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| 2 <i>For his merciful kindness is great toward us: and the truth of the LORD endureth for ever. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | For great is His mercy toward us, and the faithfulness of the LORD endures forever. Praise the LORD. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 15:4; Rom 15:11; Ps 67:3; Rev 5:9; Ps 86:9
v2 — Isa 25:1; Ps 103:11; Ps 89:1; Ps 100:4-5; 1 John 5:6

Psalm 118

The psalmist gives thanks to the LORD for His enduring mercy, recounting how God answered him in distress and became his salvation when enemies surrounded him on every side. He proclaims that the stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone, and blessed is he who comes in the name of the LORD.

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| 1 <i>O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: because his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; His mercy endures forever. |
| 2 <i>Let Israel now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Let Israel say: "His mercy endures forever." |
| 3 <i>Let the house of Aaron now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Let the house of Aaron say: "His mercy endures forever." |
| 4 <i>Let them now that fear the LORD say, that his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Let those who fear the LORD say: "His mercy endures forever." |
| 5 <i>I called upon the LORD in distress: the LORD answered me, and set me in a large place.</i> | When hard pressed, I cried to the LORD; He brought me into a spacious place. |
| 6 <i>The LORD is on my side; I will not fear: what can man do unto me?</i> | The LORD is on my side; I will not fear. What can man do to me? |
| 7 <i>The LORD taketh my part with them that help me: therefore shall I see my desire upon them that hate me.</i> | The LORD is with me; He is my helper. I look in triumph on my enemies. |
| 8 <i>It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in man.</i> | It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in man. |

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| 9 | <i>It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in princes.</i> | It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in princes. |
| 10 | <i>All nations compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD will I destroy them.</i> | All the nations surrounded me, but in the name of the LORD I cut them down. |
| 11 | <i>They compassed me about; yea, they compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.</i> | They surrounded me on every side, but in the name of the LORD I cut them down. |
| 12 | <i>They compassed me about like bees; they are quenched as the fire of thorns: for in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.</i> | They swarmed around me like bees, but they were consumed as quickly as burning thorns; in the name of the LORD I cut them down. |
| 13 | <i>Thou hast thrust sore at me that I might fall: but the LORD helped me.</i> | I was pushed back and about to fall, but the LORD helped me. |
| 14 | <i>The LORD is my strength and song, and is become my salvation.</i> | The LORD is my strength and my defense; He has become my salvation. |
| 15 | <i>The voice of rejoicing and salvation is in the tabernacles of the righteous: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.</i> | Shouts of joy and victory resound in the tents of the righteous: "The LORD's right hand has done mighty things!" |
| 16 | <i>The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.</i> | The LORD's right hand is lifted high; the LORD's right hand has done mighty things! |
| 17 | <i>I shall not die, but live, and declare the works of the LORD.</i> | I will not die but live, and will proclaim what the LORD has done. |
| 18 | <i>The LORD hath chastened me sore: but he hath not given me over unto death.</i> | The LORD has chastened me severely, but He has not given me over to death. |
| 19 | <i>Open to me the gates of righteousness: I will go into them, and I will praise the LORD:</i> | Open for me the gates of the righteous; I will enter and give thanks to the LORD. |
| 20 | <i>This gate of the LORD, into which the righteous shall enter.</i> | This is the gate of the LORD through which the righteous may enter. |

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| 21 <i>I will praise thee: for thou hast heard me, and art become my salvation.</i> | I will give You thanks, for You answered me; You have become my salvation. |
| 22 <i>The stone which the builders refused is become the head stone of the corner.</i> | The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone; |
| 23 <i>This is the LORD'S doing; it is marvellous in our eyes.</i> | the LORD has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes. |
| 24 <i>This is the day which the LORD hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.</i> | The LORD has done it this very day; let us rejoice and be glad in it. |
| 25 <i>Save now, I beseech thee, O LORD: O LORD, I beseech thee, send now prosperity.</i> | LORD, save us! LORD, grant us success! |
| 26 <i>Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the LORD: we have blessed you out of the house of the LORD.</i> | Blessed is He who comes in the name of the LORD. From the house of the LORD we bless You. |
| 27 <i>God is the LORD, which hath shewed us light: bind the sacrifice with cords, even unto the horns of the altar.</i> | The LORD is God, and He has made His light shine on us. With boughs in hand, join in the festal procession up to the horns of the altar. |
| 28 <i>Thou art my God, and I will praise thee: thou art my God, I will exalt thee.</i> | You are my God, and I will praise You; You are my God, and I will exalt You. |
| 29 <i>O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good; His mercy endures forever. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 107:1; Ps 106:1; Jer 33:11; Ps 118:29
v5 — Ps 18:19; Ps 18:6; Ps 120:1; Ps 107:19; Ps 130:1-2
v6 — Heb 13:6; Rom 8:31; Ps 56:4; Ps 56:11; Mic 7:8-10
v8 — Ps 40:4; Jer 17:5-7; Ps 62:8-9; Mic 7:5-7

v14 — Isa 12:2; Ps 18:2; Ps 27:1; Ex 15:2-6; Matt 1:21-23
v17 — John 11:4; Ps 71:17-18; Isa 38:16-20; Ps 6:5; Ps 73:28
v18 — 1 Cor 11:32; Job 5:17-18; 2 Cor 6:9; Prov 3:11-12; Ps 94:12-13
v22 — Luke 20:17; Matt 21:42; 1 Pet 2:4-8; Acts 4:11; Mark 12:10-11
v24 — Ps 84:10; Isa 58:13; Neh 8:10; 2 Chr 20:26-28; 1 Kgs 8:66
v26 — Luke 19:38; Matt 21:9; Matt 23:39; John 12:13; Mark 11:9-10
v27 — Ps 18:28; John 8:12; 1 Pet 2:9; Isa 60:1; Isa 9:2
v28 — Isa 25:1; Ps 146:2; Ex 15:2; Isa 12:2; Isa 25:9

Psalm 119

The longest chapter in the Bible is an acrostic poem of 176 verses divided into twenty-two sections, one for each letter of the Hebrew alphabet, with every verse in each section beginning with that letter. The psalmist pours out sustained devotion to God's word — His law, statutes, precepts, commandments, and testimonies — pleading for understanding, delighting in obedience, and finding light, comfort, and life in Scripture through every trial.

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| 1 | <i>Blessed are the undefiled in the way,
who walk in the law of the LORD.</i> | Blessed are those whose ways are
blameless, who walk according to the
law of the LORD. |
| 2 | <i>Blessed are they that keep his
testimonies, and that seek him with the
whole heart.</i> | Blessed are those who keep His
statutes and seek Him with all their
heart — |
| 3 | <i>They also do no iniquity: they walk in
his ways.</i> | they do no wrong but follow His ways. |
| 4 | <i>Thou hast commanded us to keep thy
precepts diligently.</i> | You have laid down precepts that are
to be fully obeyed. |
| 5 | <i>O that my ways were directed to keep
thy statutes!</i> | O that my ways were directed to keep
Your statutes! |
| 6 | <i>Then shall I not be ashamed, when I
have respect unto all thy
commandments.</i> | Then I would not be put to shame
when I consider all Your commands. |
| 7 | <i>I will praise thee with uprightness of
heart, when I shall have learned thy
righteous judgments.</i> | I will praise You with an upright heart
as I learn Your righteous laws. |
| 8 | <i>I will keep thy statutes: O forsake me
not utterly.</i> | I will obey Your decrees; do not utterly
forsake me. |

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| 9 | <i>Wherewithal shall a young man cleanse his way? by taking heed thereto according to thy word.</i> | How can a young person stay on the path of purity? By living according to Your word. |
| 10 | <i>With my whole heart have I sought thee: O let me not wander from thy commandments.</i> | I seek You with all my heart; do not let me stray from Your commands. |
| 11 | <i>Thy word have I hid in mine heart, that I might not sin against thee.</i> | I have hidden Your word in my heart that I might not sin against You. |
| 12 | <i>Blessed art thou, O LORD: teach me thy statutes.</i> | Praise be to You, LORD; teach me Your decrees. |
| 13 | <i>With my lips have I declared all the judgments of thy mouth.</i> | With my lips I recount all the laws that come from Your mouth. |
| 14 | <i>I have rejoiced in the way of thy testimonies, as much as in all riches.</i> | I rejoice in following Your statutes as one rejoices in great riches. |
| 15 | <i>I will meditate in thy precepts, and have respect unto thy ways.</i> | I meditate on Your precepts and consider Your ways. |
| 16 | <i>I will delight myself in thy statutes: I will not forget thy word.</i> | I delight in Your decrees; I will not neglect Your word. |
| 17 | <i>Deal bountifully with thy servant, that I may live, and keep thy word.</i> | Be good to Your servant while I live, that I may obey Your word. |
| 18 | <i>Open thou mine eyes, that I may behold wondrous things out of thy law.</i> | Open my eyes that I may see wonderful things in Your law. |
| 19 | <i>I am a stranger in the earth: hide not thy commandments from me.</i> | I am a stranger on earth; do not hide Your commands from me. |
| 20 | <i>My soul breaketh for the longing that it hath unto thy judgments at all times.</i> | My soul is consumed with longing for Your laws at all times. |
| 21 | <i>Thou hast rebuked the proud that are cursed, which do err from thy commandments.</i> | You rebuke the arrogant, who are accursed, those who stray from Your commands. |
| 22 | <i>Remove from me reproach and contempt; for I have kept thy testimonies.</i> | Remove from me their scorn and contempt, for I keep Your statutes. |

- 23 *Princes also did sit and speak against me: but thy servant did meditate in thy statutes.* Though rulers sit together and slander me, Your servant will meditate on Your decrees.
- 24 *Thy testimonies also are my delight and my counsellors.* Your statutes are my delight; they are my counselors.
- 25 *My soul cleaveth unto the dust: quicken thou me according to thy word.* I am laid low in the dust; preserve my life according to Your word.
- 26 *I have declared my ways, and thou heardest me: teach me thy statutes.* I gave an account of my ways and You answered me; teach me Your decrees.
- 27 *Make me to understand the way of thy precepts: so shall I talk of thy wondrous works.* Cause me to understand the way of Your precepts, that I may meditate on Your wonderful deeds.
- 28 *My soul melteth for heaviness: strengthen thou me according unto thy word.* My soul is weary with sorrow; strengthen me according to Your word.
- 29 *Remove from me the way of lying: and grant me thy law graciously.* Keep me from deceitful ways; be gracious to me and teach me Your law.
- 30 *I have chosen the way of truth: thy judgments have I laid before me.* I have chosen the way of faithfulness; I have set my heart on Your laws.
- 31 *I have stuck unto thy testimonies: O LORD, put me not to shame.* I hold fast to Your statutes, LORD; do not let me be put to shame.
- 32 *I will run the way of thy commandments, when thou shalt enlarge my heart.* I run in the path of Your commands, for You have broadened my understanding.
- 33 *Teach me, O LORD, the way of thy statutes; and I shall keep it unto the end.* Teach me, LORD, the way of Your decrees, that I may follow it to the end.
- 34 *Give me understanding, and I shall keep thy law; yea, I shall observe it with my whole heart.* Give me understanding, so that I may keep Your law and obey it with all my heart.

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| 35 | <i>Make me to go in the path of thy commandments; for therein do I delight.</i> | Direct me in the path of Your commands, for there I find delight. |
| 36 | <i>Incline my heart unto thy testimonies, and not to covetousness.</i> | Turn my heart toward Your statutes and not toward selfish gain. |
| 37 | <i>Turn away mine eyes from beholding vanity; and quicken thou me in thy way.</i> | Turn my eyes away from worthless things; preserve my life according to Your word. |
| 38 | <i>Stablish thy word unto thy servant, who is devoted to thy fear.</i> | Fulfill Your promise to Your servant, so that You may be feared. |
| 39 | <i>Turn away my reproach which I fear: for thy judgments are good.</i> | Take away the disgrace I dread, for Your laws are good. |
| 40 | <i>Behold, I have longed after thy precepts: quicken me in thy righteousness.</i> | How I long for Your precepts! In Your righteousness preserve my life. |
| 41 | <i>Let thy mercies come also unto me, O LORD, even thy salvation, according to thy word.</i> | Let Your mercies come also to me, O LORD, even Your salvation, according to Your word. |
| 42 | <i>So shall I have wherewith to answer him that reproacheth me: for I trust in thy word.</i> | then I can answer anyone who taunts me, for I trust in your word. |
| 43 | <i>And take not the word of truth utterly out of my mouth; for I have hoped in thy judgments.</i> | Never take Your word of truth from my mouth, for I have put my hope in Your laws. |
| 44 | <i>So shall I keep thy law continually for ever and ever.</i> | I will always obey Your law, for ever and ever. |
| 45 | <i>And I will walk at liberty: for I seek thy precepts.</i> | I will walk about in freedom, for I have sought out Your precepts. |
| 46 | <i>I will speak of thy testimonies also before kings, and will not be ashamed.</i> | I will speak of Your statutes before kings and will not be put to shame, |
| 47 | <i>And I will delight myself in thy commandments, which I have loved.</i> | for I delight in Your commands because I love them. |

- 48 *My hands also will I lift up unto thy commandments, which I have loved; and I will meditate in thy statutes.* I reach out for Your commands, which I love, and I meditate on Your decrees.
- 49 *Remember the word unto thy servant, upon which thou hast caused me to hope.* Remember Your word to Your servant, for You have given me hope.
- 50 *This is my comfort in my affliction: for thy word hath quickened me.* My comfort in my suffering is this: Your promise preserves my life.
- 51 *The proud have had me greatly in derision: yet have I not declined from thy law.* The arrogant mock me without restraint, but I do not turn from Your law.
- 52 *I remembered thy judgments of old, O LORD; and have comforted myself.* I remember, LORD, Your ancient laws, and I find comfort in them.
- 53 *Horror hath taken hold upon me because of the wicked that forsake thy law.* Indignation grips me because of the wicked, who have forsaken your law.
- 54 *Thy statutes have been my songs in the house of my pilgrimage.* Your decrees are the theme of my song wherever I lodge.
- 55 *I have remembered thy name, O LORD, in the night, and have kept thy law.* In the night, LORD, I remember Your name, that I may keep Your law.
- 56 *This I had, because I kept thy precepts.* This has been my practice: I obey Your precepts.
- 57 *Thou art my portion, O LORD: I have said that I would keep thy words.* You are my portion, LORD; I have promised to obey Your words.
- 58 *I intreated thy favour with my whole heart: be merciful unto me according to thy word.* I have sought Your face with all my heart; be gracious to me according to Your promise.
- 59 *I thought on my ways, and turned my feet unto thy testimonies.* I have considered my ways and have turned my steps to Your statutes.
- 60 *I made haste, and delayed not to keep thy commandments.* I will hasten and not delay to obey Your commands.

- 61 *The bands of the wicked have robbed me: but I have not forgotten thy law.* Though the wicked bind me with ropes, I will not forget your law.
- 62 *At midnight I will rise to give thanks unto thee because of thy righteous judgments.* At midnight I rise to give you thanks for your righteous laws.
- 63 *I am a companion of all them that fear thee, and of them that keep thy precepts.* I am a friend to all who fear you, to all who follow your precepts.
- 64 *The earth, O LORD, is full of thy mercy: teach me thy statutes.* The earth, O LORD, is full of Your mercy; teach me Your statutes.
- 65 *Thou hast dealt well with thy servant, O LORD, according unto thy word.* Do good to Your servant, LORD, according to Your word.
- 66 *Teach me good judgment and knowledge: for I have believed thy commandments.* Teach me knowledge and good judgment, for I trust Your commands.
- 67 *Before I was afflicted I went astray: but now have I kept thy word.* Before I was afflicted I went astray, but now I obey Your word.
- 68 *Thou art good, and doest good; teach me thy statutes.* You are good, and what You do is good; teach me Your decrees.
- 69 *The proud have forged a lie against me: but I will keep thy precepts with my whole heart.* Though the arrogant have smeared me with lies, I keep Your precepts with all my heart.
- 70 *Their heart is as fat as grease; but I delight in thy law.* Their hearts are callous and unfeeling, but I delight in Your law.
- 71 *It is good for me that I have been afflicted; that I might learn thy statutes.* It was good for me to be afflicted so that I might learn Your decrees.
- 72 *The law of thy mouth is better unto me than thousands of gold and silver.* The law from Your mouth is more precious to me than thousands of pieces of silver and gold.
- 73 *Thy hands have made me and fashioned me: give me understanding, that I may learn thy commandments.* Your hands made me and formed me; give me understanding to learn Your commands.

- 74 *They that fear thee will be glad when they see me; because I have hoped in thy word.* May those who fear You rejoice when they see me, for I have put my hope in Your word.
- 75 *I know, O LORD, that thy judgments are right, and that thou in faithfulness hast afflicted me.* I know, LORD, that Your laws are righteous, and that in faithfulness You have afflicted me.
- 76 *Let, I pray thee, thy merciful kindness be for my comfort, according to thy word unto thy servant.* Let, I pray, Your merciful kindness be for my comfort, according to Your word to Your servant.
- 77 *Let thy tender mercies come unto me, that I may live: for thy law is my delight.* Let Your compassion come to me that I may live, for Your law is my delight.
- 78 *Let the proud be ashamed; for they dealt perversely with me without a cause: but I will meditate in thy precepts.* May the arrogant be put to shame for wronging me without cause; but I will meditate on Your precepts.
- 79 *Let those that fear thee turn unto me, and those that have known thy testimonies.* May those who fear You turn to me, those who understand Your statutes.
- 80 *Let my heart be sound in thy statutes; that I be not ashamed.* May I wholeheartedly follow Your decrees, that I may not be put to shame.
- 81 *My soul fainteth for thy salvation: but I hope in thy word.* My soul faints with longing for Your salvation, but I have put my hope in Your word.
- 82 *Mine eyes fail for thy word, saying, When wilt thou comfort me?* My eyes fail, looking for Your promise; I say, "When will You comfort me?"
- 83 *For I am become like a bottle in the smoke; yet do I not forget thy statutes.* Though I am like a wineskin in the smoke, I do not forget Your decrees.
- 84 *How many are the days of thy servant? when wilt thou execute judgment on them that persecute me?* How long must Your servant wait? When will You punish my persecutors?

- 85 *The proud have digged pits for me,
which are not after thy law.* The arrogant dig pits for me, contrary
to Your law.
- 86 *All thy commandments are faithful:
they persecute me wrongfully; help
thou me.* All Your commands are trustworthy;
help me, for I am being persecuted
without cause.
- 87 *They had almost consumed me upon
earth; but I forsook not thy precepts.* They almost wiped me from the earth,
but I have not forsaken Your precepts.
- 88 *Quicken me after thy lovingkindness;
so shall I keep the testimony of thy
mouth.* Quicken me according to Your
lovingkindness, so I shall keep the
testimony of Your mouth.
- 89 *For ever, O LORD, thy word is settled
in heaven.* Your word, LORD, is eternal; it stands
firm in the heavens.
- 90 *Thy faithfulness is unto all
generations: thou hast established the
earth, and it abideth.* Your faithfulness continues through all
generations; You established the earth,
and it endures.
- 91 *They continue this day according to
thine ordinances: for all are thy
servants.* Your laws endure to this day, for all
things serve You.
- 92 *Unless thy law had been my delights, I
should then have perished in mine
affliction.* If Your law had not been my delight, I
would have perished in my affliction.
- 93 *I will never forget thy precepts: for
with them thou hast quickened me.* I will never forget Your precepts, for
by them You have preserved my life.
- 94 *I am thine, save me; for I have sought
thy precepts.* Save me, for I am Yours; I have sought
out Your precepts.
- 95 *The wicked have waited for me to
destroy me: but I will consider thy
testimonies.* The wicked are waiting to destroy me,
but I will ponder your statutes.
- 96 *I have seen an end of all perfection:
but thy commandment is exceeding
broad.* To all perfection I see a limit, but your
commands are boundless.
- 97 *O how love I thy law! it is my
meditation all the day.* Oh, how I love your law! I meditate on
it all day long.

- 98 *Thou through thy commandments hast made me wiser than mine enemies: for they are ever with me.* Your commands are always with me and make me wiser than my enemies.
- 99 *I have more understanding than all my teachers: for thy testimonies are my meditation.* I have more insight than all my teachers, for I meditate on your statutes.
- 10 *I understand more than the ancients, because I keep thy precepts.* I have more understanding than the elders, for I obey your precepts.
- 10 *I have refrained my feet from every evil way; that I might keep thy word.* I have kept my feet from every evil path so that I might obey your word.
- 10 *I have not departed from thy judgments: for thou hast taught me.* I have not departed from your laws, for you yourself have taught me.
- 10 *How sweet are thy words unto my taste! yea, sweeter than honey to my mouth!* How sweet are your words to my taste, sweeter than honey to my mouth!
- 10 *Through thy precepts I get understanding: therefore I hate every false way.* I gain understanding from your precepts; therefore I hate every wrong path.
- 10 *Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.* Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path.
- 10 *I have sworn, and I will perform it, that I will keep thy righteous judgments.* I have taken an oath and confirmed it, that I will follow your righteous laws.
- 10 *I am afflicted very much: quicken me, O LORD, according unto thy word.* I have suffered much; preserve my life, LORD, according to Your word.
- 10 *Accept, I beseech thee, the freewill offerings of my mouth, O LORD, and teach me thy judgments.* Accept, LORD, the willing praise of my mouth, and teach me Your laws.
- 10 *My soul is continually in my hand: yet do I not forget thy law.* Though I constantly take my life in my hands, I will not forget Your law.
- 11 *The wicked have laid a snare for me: yet I erred not from thy precepts.* The wicked have set a snare for me, but I have not strayed from your precepts.

11	<i>Thy testimonies have I taken as an</i>	Your statutes are my heritage forever;
1	<i>heritage for ever: for they are the</i>	they are the joy of my heart.
	<i>rejoicing of my heart.</i>	
11	<i>I have inclined mine heart to perform</i>	My heart is set on keeping your
2	<i>thy statutes always, even unto the end.</i>	decrees to the very end.
11	<i>I hate vain thoughts: but thy law do I</i>	I hate double-minded people, but I love
3	<i>love.</i>	your law.
11	<i>Thou art my hiding place and my</i>	You are my refuge and my shield; I
4	<i>shield: I hope in thy word.</i>	have put my hope in your word.
11	<i>Depart from me, ye evildoers: for I</i>	Away from me, you evildoers, that I
5	<i>will keep the commandments of my</i>	may keep the commands of my God!
	<i>God.</i>	
11	<i>Uphold me according unto thy word,</i>	Sustain me, my God, according to
6	<i>that I may live: and let me not be</i>	Your promise, and I will live; do not
	<i>ashamed of my hope.</i>	let my hopes be dashed.
11	<i>Hold thou me up, and I shall be safe:</i>	Uphold me, and I will be delivered; I
7	<i>and I will have respect unto thy</i>	will always have regard for your
	<i>statutes continually.</i>	decrees.
11	<i>Thou hast trodden down all them that</i>	You reject all who stray from your
8	<i>err from thy statutes: for their deceit</i>	decrees, for their delusions come to
	<i>is falsehood.</i>	nothing.
11	<i>Thou puttest away all the wicked of</i>	All the wicked of the earth you discard
9	<i>the earth like dross: therefore I love</i>	like dross; therefore I love your
	<i>thy testimonies.</i>	statutes.
12	<i>My flesh trembleth for fear of thee;</i>	My flesh trembles in fear of you; I
0	<i>and I am afraid of thy judgments.</i>	stand in awe of your laws.
12	<i>I have done judgment and justice:</i>	I have done what is righteous and just;
1	<i>leave me not to mine oppressors.</i>	do not leave me to my oppressors.
12	<i>Be surety for thy servant for good: let</i>	Ensure your servant's well-being; do
2	<i>not the proud oppress me.</i>	not let the arrogant oppress me.
12	<i>Mine eyes fail for thy salvation, and</i>	My eyes fail, looking for your
3	<i>for the word of thy righteousness.</i>	salvation, looking for your righteous
		promise.

12	<i>Deal with thy servant according unto</i>	Deal with your servant according to
4	<i>thy mercy, and teach me thy statutes.</i>	your mercy and teach me your decrees.
12	<i>I am thy servant; give me</i>	I am your servant; give me
5	<i>understanding, that I may know thy</i>	discernment that I may understand
	<i>testimonies.</i>	your statutes.
12	<i>It is time for thee, LORD, to work: for</i>	It is time for You to act, LORD; Your
6	<i>they have made void thy law.</i>	law is being broken.
12	<i>Therefore I love thy commandments</i>	Because I love Your commands more
7	<i>above gold; yea, above fine gold.</i>	than gold, more than pure gold,
12	<i>Therefore I esteem all thy precepts</i>	and because I consider all Your
8	<i>concerning all things to be right; and</i>	precepts right, I hate every wrong path.
	<i>I hate every false way.</i>	
12	<i>Thy testimonies are wonderful:</i>	Your statutes are wonderful; therefore
9	<i>therefore doth my soul keep them.</i>	I obey them.
13	<i>The entrance of thy words giveth</i>	The unfolding of Your words gives
0	<i>light; it giveth understanding unto the</i>	light; it gives understanding to the
	<i>simple.</i>	simple.
13	<i>I opened my mouth, and panted: for I</i>	I open my mouth and pant, longing for
1	<i>longed for thy commandments.</i>	Your commands.
13	<i>Look thou upon me, and be merciful</i>	Turn to me and have mercy on me, as
2	<i>unto me, as thou usest to do unto</i>	You always do to those who love Your
	<i>those that love thy name.</i>	name.
13	<i>Order my steps in thy word: and let</i>	Direct my footsteps according to Your
3	<i>not any iniquity have dominion over</i>	word; let no iniquity rule over me.
	<i>me.</i>	
13	<i>Deliver me from the oppression of</i>	Deliver me from the oppression of
4	<i>man: so will I keep thy precepts.</i>	man, so I will keep Your precepts.
13	<i>Make thy face to shine upon thy</i>	Make Your face shine on Your servant
5	<i>servant; and teach me thy statutes.</i>	and teach me Your decrees.
13	<i>Rivers of waters run down mine eyes,</i>	Streams of tears flow from my eyes,
6	<i>because they keep not thy law.</i>	for Your law is not obeyed.
13	<i>Righteous art thou, O LORD, and</i>	You are righteous, LORD, and Your
7	<i>upright are thy judgments.</i>	laws are right.

13	<i>Thy testimonies that thou hast</i>	The statutes You have laid down are
8	<i>commanded are righteous and very</i>	righteous; they are fully trustworthy.
	<i>faithful.</i>	
13	<i>My zeal hath consumed me, because</i>	My zeal wears me out, for my enemies
9	<i>mine enemies have forgotten thy</i>	ignore Your words.
	<i>words.</i>	
14	<i>Thy word is very pure: therefore thy</i>	Your promises have been thoroughly
0	<i>servant loveth it.</i>	tested, and Your servant loves them.
14	<i>I am small and despised: yet do not I</i>	Though I am lowly and despised, I do
1	<i>forget thy precepts.</i>	not forget Your precepts.
14	<i>Thy righteousness is an everlasting</i>	Your righteousness is everlasting and
2	<i>righteousness, and thy law is the</i>	Your law is true.
	<i>truth.</i>	
14	<i>Trouble and anguish have taken hold</i>	Trouble and distress have come upon
3	<i>on me: yet thy commandments are my</i>	me, but Your commands give me
	<i>delights.</i>	delight.
14	<i>The righteousness of thy testimonies is</i>	Your statutes are always righteous;
4	<i>everlasting: give me understanding,</i>	give me understanding that I may live.
	<i>and I shall live.</i>	
14	<i>I cried with my whole heart; hear me,</i>	I call with all my heart; answer me,
5	<i>O LORD: I will keep thy statutes.</i>	LORD, and I will obey Your decrees.
14	<i>I cried unto thee; save me, and I shall</i>	I call out to You; save me and I will
6	<i>keep thy testimonies.</i>	keep Your statutes.
14	<i>I prevented the dawning of the</i>	I rise before dawn and cry for help; I
7	<i>morning, and cried: I hoped in thy</i>	have put my hope in Your word.
	<i>word.</i>	
14	<i>Mine eyes prevent the night watches,</i>	My eyes stay open through the watches
8	<i>that I might meditate in thy word.</i>	of the night, that I may meditate on
		Your promises.
14	<i>Hear my voice according unto thy</i>	Hear my voice according to Your
9	<i>lovingkindness: O LORD, quicken me</i>	lovingkindness; O LORD, quicken me
	<i>according to thy judgment.</i>	according to Your judgment.

15	<i>They draw nigh that follow after</i>	Those who devise wicked schemes are
0	<i>mischief; they are far from thy law.</i>	near, but they are far from Your law.
15	<i>Thou art near, O LORD; and all thy</i>	Yet You are near, LORD, and all Your
1	<i>commandments are truth.</i>	commands are true.
15	<i>Concerning thy testimonies, I have</i>	Long ago I learned from Your statutes
2	<i>known of old that thou hast founded</i>	that You established them to last
	<i>them for ever.</i>	forever.
15	<i>Consider mine affliction, and deliver</i>	Look on my suffering and deliver me,
3	<i>me: for I do not forget thy law.</i>	for I have not forgotten Your law.
15	<i>Plead my cause, and deliver me:</i>	Defend my cause and redeem me;
4	<i>quicken me according to thy word.</i>	preserve my life according to Your
		promise.
15	<i>Salvation is far from the wicked: for</i>	Salvation is far from the wicked, for
5	<i>they seek not thy statutes.</i>	they do not seek out your decrees.
15	<i>Great are thy tender mercies, O</i>	Your compassion, LORD, is great;
6	<i>LORD: quicken me according to thy</i>	preserve my life according to Your
	<i>judgments.</i>	laws.
15	<i>Many are my persecutors and mine</i>	Many are the foes who persecute me,
7	<i>enemies; yet do I not decline from thy</i>	but I have not turned from Your
	<i>testimonies.</i>	statutes.
15	<i>I beheld the transgressors, and was</i>	I look on the faithless with loathing,
8	<i>grieved; because they kept not thy</i>	for they do not obey Your word.
	<i>word.</i>	
15	<i>Consider how I love thy precepts:</i>	Consider how I love Your precepts;
9	<i>quicken me, O LORD, according to</i>	quicken me, O LORD, according to
	<i>thy lovingkindness.</i>	Your lovingkindness.
16	<i>Thy word is true from the beginning:</i>	All Your words are true; all Your
0	<i>and every one of thy righteous</i>	righteous laws are eternal.
	<i>judgments endureth for ever.</i>	
16	<i>Princes have persecuted me without a</i>	Rulers persecute me without cause, but
1	<i>cause: but my heart standeth in awe of</i>	my heart trembles at Your word.
	<i>thy word.</i>	

16	<i>I rejoice at thy word, as one that</i>	I rejoice in Your promise like one who
2	<i>findeth great spoil.</i>	finds great treasure.
16	<i>I hate and abhor lying; but thy law do</i>	I hate and detest falsehood but I love
3	<i>I love.</i>	Your law.
16	<i>Seven times a day do I praise thee</i>	Seven times a day I praise You for
4	<i>because of thy righteous judgments.</i>	Your righteous laws.
16	<i>Great peace have they which love thy</i>	Great peace have those who love Your
5	<i>law: and nothing shall offend them.</i>	law, and nothing can make them stumble.
16	<i>LORD, I have hoped for thy salvation,</i>	I wait for Your salvation, LORD, and I
6	<i>and done thy commandments.</i>	follow Your commands.
16	<i>My soul hath kept thy testimonies; and</i>	I obey Your statutes, for I love them
7	<i>I love them exceedingly.</i>	greatly.
16	<i>I have kept thy precepts and thy</i>	I obey Your precepts and Your
8	<i>testimonies: for all my ways are</i>	statutes, for all my ways are known to
	<i>before thee.</i>	You.
16	<i>Let my cry come near before thee, O</i>	May my cry come before You, LORD;
9	<i>LORD: give me understanding</i>	give me understanding according to
	<i>according to thy word.</i>	Your word.
17	<i>Let my supplication come before thee:</i>	May my supplication come before
0	<i>deliver me according to thy word.</i>	You; deliver me according to Your promise.
17	<i>My lips shall utter praise, when thou</i>	May my lips overflow with praise, for
1	<i>hast taught me thy statutes.</i>	You teach me Your decrees.
17	<i>My tongue shall speak of thy word:</i>	May my tongue sing of Your word, for
2	<i>for all thy commandments are</i>	all Your commands are righteous.
	<i>righteousness.</i>	
17	<i>Let thine hand help me; for I have</i>	May Your hand be ready to help me,
3	<i>chosen thy precepts.</i>	for I have chosen Your precepts.
17	<i>I have longed for thy salvation, O</i>	I long for Your salvation, LORD, and
4	<i>LORD; and thy law is my delight.</i>	Your law gives me delight.
17	<i>Let my soul live, and it shall praise</i>	Let me live that I may praise You, and
5	<i>thee; and let thy judgments help me.</i>	may Your laws sustain me.

17	<i>I have gone astray like a lost sheep;</i>	I have strayed like a lost sheep. Seek
6	<i>seek thy servant; for I do not forget</i>	Your servant, for I have not forgotten
	<i>thy commandments.</i>	Your commands.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 11:28; Ezek 11:20; Jas 1:25; Ps 128:1; John 13:17
- v2 — Jer 29:13; Deut 4:29; Ps 119:10; John 14:23; Ps 25:10
- v5 — Ps 51:10; 2 Thess 3:5; Heb 13:21; Jer 31:33; Rom 7:22-24
- v9 — 2 Tim 2:22; Jas 1:21-25; 2 Tim 3:15-17; Josh 1:7; Ps 25:7
- v11 — Ps 37:31; Col 3:16; Ps 40:8; Jer 15:16; Ps 1:2
- v18 — Eph 1:17-18; Acts 26:18; Isa 32:3; Isa 35:5; Matt 13:13
- v37 — 1 John 2:16; Prov 4:25; Isa 33:15; Num 15:39; Job 31:1
- v71 — Heb 12:10-11; Ps 119:67; 1 Cor 11:32; Ps 94:12-13
- v105 — Prov 6:23; Ps 43:3; Ps 18:28; 2 Pet 1:19; Job 29:3
- v114 — Ps 91:1-2; Ps 32:7; Ps 3:3; Isa 32:2; Ps 130:5-6
- v130 — Ps 119:105; Prov 6:23; 2 Cor 4:6; Acts 26:18; Ps 19:7
- v165 — Prov 3:1-2; Isa 32:17; Isa 26:3; John 14:27; Phil 4:7

Psalm 120

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist cries to the LORD in distress over lying tongues and deceitful lips, lamenting that he lives among those who hate peace. He has dwelt too long among hostile strangers, and when he speaks peace, they want war.

1	<i>In my distress I cried unto the LORD,</i>	I call on the LORD in my distress, and
	<i>and he heard me.</i>	He answers me.
2	<i>Deliver my soul, O LORD, from lying</i>	Save me, LORD, from lying lips and
	<i>lips, and from a deceitful tongue.</i>	from deceitful tongues.
3	<i>What shall be given unto thee? or</i>	What will He do to You, and what
	<i>what shall be done unto thee, thou</i>	more besides, You deceitful tongue?
	<i>false tongue?</i>	
4	<i>Sharp arrows of the mighty, with</i>	He will punish You with a warrior's
	<i>coals of juniper.</i>	sharp arrows, with burning coals of the
		broom bush.

5	<i>Woe is me, that I sojourn in Mesech, that I dwell in the tents of Kedar!</i>	Woe to me that I stay in Meshech, that I live among the tents of Kedar!
6	<i>My soul hath long dwelt with him that hateth peace.</i>	Too long have I lived among those who hate peace.
7	<i>I am for peace: but when I speak, they are for war.</i>	I am for peace; but when I speak, they are for war.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 18:6; Jonah 2:2; Ps 118:5; Heb 5:7; Ps 50:15
- v2 — Ps 140:1-3
- v4 — Jas 3:5-8
- v5 — Gen 10:2
- v6 — Matt 10:16; Ps 57:4; Ezek 2:6
- v7 — Matt 5:9; Ps 109:4; Heb 12:14; Ps 34:14

Psalm 121

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist lifts his eyes to the hills and asks where his help comes from, answering that it comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth. The LORD neither slumbers nor sleeps but watches over His people, shading them by day and guarding them by night, preserving their going out and coming in forevermore.

1	<i>I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help.</i>	I lift up my eyes to the mountains — where does my help come from?
2	<i>My help cometh from the LORD, which made heaven and earth.</i>	My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth.
3	<i>He will not suffer thy foot to be moved: he that keepeth thee will not slumber.</i>	He will not let Your foot slip — he who watches over you will not slumber;
4	<i>Behold, he that keepeth Israel shall neither slumber nor sleep.</i>	indeed, He who watches over Israel will neither slumber nor sleep.
5	<i>The LORD is thy keeper: the LORD is thy shade upon thy right hand.</i>	The LORD watches over You — the LORD is Your shade at Your right hand;

6	<i>The sun shall not smite thee by day, nor the moon by night.</i>	the sun will not harm You by day, nor the moon by night.
7	<i>The LORD shall preserve thee from all evil: he shall preserve thy soul.</i>	The LORD will keep You from all harm — He will watch over Your life;
8	<i>The LORD shall preserve thy going out and thy coming in from this time forth, and even for evermore.</i>	the LORD will watch over Your coming and going both now and forevermore.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 120:1; Ps 123:1; Jer 3:23; Isa 2:3; Ps 2:6
- v2 — Isa 41:13; Ps 124:8; Heb 13:6; Isa 40:28-29; Ps 146:5-6
- v3 — Prov 3:26; Prov 3:23; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 91:12; Ps 66:9
- v4 — Ps 127:1; Isa 27:3; Ps 32:7-8
- v5 — Isa 25:4; Ps 91:1; Ps 16:8; Ex 13:21; Isa 4:5-6
- v6 — Rev 7:16; Isa 49:10; Ps 91:5-10; Jonah 4:8
- v7 — 2 Tim 4:18; Ps 91:9-12; Ps 41:2; Prov 12:21; Ps 145:20
- v8 — Deut 28:6; Prov 2:8; Prov 3:6; Ps 113:2; Ezra 8:31

Psalm 122

A Song of degrees, of David.

David rejoices at the call to go to the house of the LORD, celebrating Jerusalem as the city where the tribes go up to give thanks and where the thrones of judgment stand. He prays for the peace of Jerusalem, asking prosperity for those who love her.

1	<i>I was glad when they said unto me, Let us go into the house of the LORD.</i>	I rejoiced with those who said to me, "Let us go to the house of the LORD."
2	<i>Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.</i>	Our feet are standing in Your gates, Jerusalem.
3	<i>Jerusalem is builded as a city that is compact together:</i>	Jerusalem is built like a city that is closely compacted together.
4	<i>Whither the tribes go up, the tribes of the LORD, unto the testimony of Israel, to give thanks unto the name of the LORD.</i>	That is where the tribes go up — the tribes of the LORD — to praise the name of the LORD according to the statute given to Israel.

5	<i>For there are set thrones of judgment, the thrones of the house of David.</i>	There stand the thrones for judgment, the thrones of the house of David.
6	<i>Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: they shall prosper that love thee.</i>	Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: "May those who love you be secure.
7	<i>Peace be within thy walls, and prosperity within thy palaces.</i>	May there be peace within your walls and security within your citadels."
8	<i>For my brethren and companions' sakes, I will now say, Peace be within thee.</i>	For the sake of my family and friends, I will say, "Peace be within you."
9	<i>Because of the house of the LORD our God I will seek thy good.</i>	For the sake of the house of the LORD our God, I will seek Your prosperity.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 84:10; Mic 4:2; Isa 2:3; Ps 128:1; Ps 84:1-2
- v3 — 2 Sam 5:9; Eph 2:20-21
- v4 — Deut 16:16
- v5 — Deut 17:8
- v6 — Ps 51:18; Gen 12:3; Jer 29:7; Ps 137:6-7; Num 24:9
- v7 — John 14:27; Jas 3:18; Isa 54:13
- v9 — Neh 2:10; Ps 84:10; Ps 84:1-2; John 2:17; Neh 13:14

Psalm 123

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist lifts his eyes to God who is enthroned in heaven, comparing himself to a servant watching the hand of his master, waiting for mercy. He pleads for the LORD's compassion because his soul is full of the contempt and scorn of the proud.

1	<i>Unto thee lift I up mine eyes, O thou that dwellest in the heavens.</i>	To You I lift up my eyes, O You who dwell in the heavens.
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| 2 <i>Behold, as the eyes of servants look unto the hand of their masters, and as the eyes of a maiden unto the hand of her mistress; so our eyes wait upon the LORD our God, until that he have mercy upon us.</i> | As the eyes of slaves look to the hand of their master, as the eyes of a female servant look to the hand of her mistress, so our eyes look to the LORD our God, till He shows us His mercy. |
| 3 <i>Have mercy upon us, O LORD, have mercy upon us: for we are exceedingly filled with contempt.</i> | Have mercy on us, LORD, have mercy on us, for we have endured no end of contempt. |
| 4 <i>Our soul is exceedingly filled with the scorning of those that are at ease, and with the contempt of the proud.</i> | We have endured no end of ridicule from the arrogant, of contempt from the proud. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 121:1; Ps 141:8; Ps 25:15; Ps 2:4; Ps 11:4
- v2 — Ps 130:5-6; Lam 3:25-26; Ps 25:15; Ps 40:1-3; Gen 49:18
- v3 — Luke 18:11-13; Ps 57:1
- v4 — Job 12:5; Ps 119:51; Acts 17:32

Psalm 124

A Song of degrees, of David.

David declares that if the LORD had not been on Israel's side, their enemies would have swallowed them alive and the flood would have swept them away. He blesses the LORD who did not give them over as prey, affirming that their help is in the name of the LORD, who made heaven and earth.

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| 1 <i>If it had not been the LORD who was on our side, now may Israel say;</i> | If the LORD had not been on our side — let Israel say — |
| 2 <i>If it had not been the LORD who was on our side, when men rose up against us:</i> | if the LORD had not been on our side when people attacked us, |
| 3 <i>Then they had swallowed us up quick, when their wrath was kindled against us:</i> | they would have swallowed us alive when their anger flared against us; |

4	<i>Then the waters had overwhelmed us, the stream had gone over our soul:</i>	the flood would have engulfed us, the torrent would have swept over us,
5	<i>Then the proud waters had gone over our soul.</i>	the raging waters would have swept us away.
6	<i>Blessed be the LORD, who hath not given us as a prey to their teeth.</i>	Praise be to the LORD, Who has not let us be torn by their teeth.
7	<i>Our soul is escaped as a bird out of the snare of the fowlers: the snare is broken, and we are escaped.</i>	We have escaped like a bird from the fowler's snare; the snare has been broken, and we have escaped.
8	<i>Our help is in the name of the LORD, who made heaven and earth.</i>	Our help is in the name of the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 8:31; Ps 56:9; Ps 54:4; Ps 120:1; Heb 13:5-6
- v2 — Ps 22:12-13
- v4 — Rev 17:15; Ps 69:15
- v6 — Ps 118:13; Ps 145:5-6; Ex 15:9-10; Isa 10:14-19; Ps 17:9
- v7 — Ps 91:3; Prov 6:5; Ps 25:15; 1 Sam 25:29; 2 Tim 2:26
- v8 — Ps 121:2; Acts 4:24; Ps 146:5-6; Gen 1:1; Ps 134:3

Psalm 125

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist declares that those who trust in the LORD are like Mount Zion, which cannot be shaken but endures forever, surrounded by the LORD as the mountains surround Jerusalem. He prays for peace on Israel and affirms that the scepter of the wicked will not rest on the land allotted to the righteous.

1	<i>They that trust in the LORD shall be as mount Zion, which cannot be removed, but abideth for ever.</i>	Those who trust in the LORD are like Mount Zion, which cannot be shaken but endures forever.
2	<i>As the mountains are round about Jerusalem, so the LORD is round about his people from henceforth even for ever.</i>	As the mountains surround Jerusalem, so the LORD surrounds His people both now and forevermore.

- 3

For the rod of the wicked shall not rest upon the lot of the righteous; lest the righteous put forth their hands unto iniquity.

The scepter of the wicked will not remain over the land allotted to the righteous, for then the righteous might use their hands to do evil.
- 4

Do good, O LORD, unto those that be good, and to them that are upright in their hearts.

LORD, do good to those who are good, to those who are upright in heart.
- 5

As for such as turn aside unto their crooked ways, the LORD shall lead them forth with the workers of iniquity: but peace shall be upon Israel.

But those who turn to crooked ways the LORD will banish with the evildoers. Peace be on Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 17:7-8; Ps 62:2; Prov 3:5-6; Ps 118:8-9; Ps 120:1
- v2 — Zech 2:5; Ps 121:8; Isa 4:5; Ps 34:7; John 10:28-29
- v3 — Isa 14:5-6; Prov 22:8; Ps 89:22; 1 Cor 10:13; Rev 2:10
- v4 — Ps 7:10; Ps 84:11; Ps 94:15; Ps 119:68
- v5 — Isa 59:8; Prov 2:15; Ps 128:6; Gal 6:16; Ps 40:4

Psalm 126

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist recalls the joy of the LORD's restoration of Zion, when the captives returned with laughter and singing so great that even the nations said the LORD had done great things. He prays for further restoration, declaring that those who sow in tears will reap with shouts of joy.

- 1

When the LORD turned again the captivity of Zion, we were like them that dream.

When the LORD restored the fortunes of Zion, we were like those who dreamed.
- 2

Then was our mouth filled with laughter, and our tongue with singing: then said they among the heathen, The LORD hath done great things for them.

Our mouths were filled with laughter, our tongues with songs of joy. Then it was said among the nations, "The LORD has done great things for them."

3	<i>The LORD hath done great things for us; whereof we are glad.</i>	The LORD has done great things for us, and we are filled with joy.
4	<i>Turn again our captivity, O LORD, as the streams in the south.</i>	Turn again our captivity, O LORD, as the streams in the south.
5	<i>They that sow in tears shall reap in joy.</i>	Those who sow with tears will reap with songs of joy.
6	<i>He that goeth forth and weepeth, bearing precious seed, shall doubtless come again with rejoicing, bringing his sheaves with him.</i>	Those who go out weeping, carrying seed to sow, will return with songs of joy, carrying sheaves with them.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hos 6:11; Joel 3:1; Jer 31:8-10; Ps 85:1; Ps 120:1
- v2 — Job 8:21; Isa 35:10; Zech 8:22-23; Ps 71:19; Ps 106:47-48
- v3 — Luke 1:49; Isa 66:14; Isa 51:9-11; Isa 12:4-6; Ps 66:5-6
- v4 — Ps 85:4; Isa 41:18; Ps 126:1; Isa 35:6; Isa 43:19
- v5 — Gal 6:9; Isa 35:10; John 16:20-22; Joel 2:23; Matt 5:4
- v6 — Gal 6:7-8; Isa 9:2-3; Ps 30:5; Isa 61:3; Job 11:13-17

Psalm 127

A Song of degrees, for Solomon.

Solomon declares that unless the LORD builds the house and watches over the city, the builders and watchmen labor in vain. Children are a heritage from the LORD, and the man whose quiver is full of them is blessed.

1	<i>Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it: except the LORD keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain.</i>	Unless the LORD builds the house, the builders labor in vain. Unless the LORD watches over the city, the guards stand watch in vain.
2	<i>It is vain for you to rise up early, to sit up late, to eat the bread of sorrows: for so he giveth his beloved sleep.</i>	In vain You rise early and stay up late, toiling for food to eat — for He grants sleep to those He loves.

3	<i>Lo, children are an heritage of the LORD: and the fruit of the womb is his reward.</i>	Children are a heritage from the LORD, the fruit of the womb a reward from Him.
4	<i>As arrows are in the hand of a mighty man; so are children of the youth.</i>	Like arrows in the hands of a warrior are children born in one's youth.
5	<i>Happy is the man that hath his quiver full of them: they shall not be ashamed, but they shall speak with the enemies in the gate.</i>	Blessed is the man whose quiver is full of them. They will not be put to shame when they contend with their opponents in court.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 16:9; 1 Cor 3:7; Prov 21:30-31; 1 Cor 3:9-15; Ps 33:16-18
- v2 — Eccl 5:12; Ps 4:8; Job 11:18; Ps 3:5; Eccl 2:20-23
- v3 — Ps 128:3-4; Deut 28:4; 1 Sam 1:27; Gen 48:4; Gen 33:5
- v4 — Prov 17:6; Prov 31:28; Jer 50:9
- v5 — Prov 27:11

Psalm 128

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist pronounces blessings on the man who fears the LORD and walks in His ways: he will eat the fruit of his labor, his wife will be like a fruitful vine, and his children like olive shoots around his table. He prays that this man would see the prosperity of Jerusalem and peace upon Israel all the days of his life.

1	<i>Blessed is every one that feareth the LORD; that walketh in his ways.</i>	Blessed are all who fear the LORD, Who walk in obedience to Him.
2	<i>For thou shalt eat the labour of thine hands; happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee.</i>	You will eat the fruit of Your labor; blessings and prosperity will be Yours.
3	<i>Thy wife shall be as a fruitful vine by the sides of thine house: thy children like olive plants round about thy table.</i>	Your wife will be like a fruitful vine within Your house; Your children will be like olive shoots around Your table.
4	<i>Behold, that thus shall the man be blessed that feareth the LORD.</i>	Yes, this will be the blessing for the man who fears the LORD.

5	<i>The LORD shall bless thee out of Zion: and thou shalt see the good of Jerusalem all the days of thy life.</i>	May the LORD bless You from Zion; may You see the prosperity of Jerusalem all the days of Your life.
6	<i>Yea, thou shalt see thy children's children, and peace upon Israel.</i>	May You live to see Your children's children — peace be on Israel.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 112:1; Ps 119:1; Ps 103:13; Luke 1:50; Acts 9:31
- v2 — Isa 3:10; Isa 62:8; Isa 65:21-23; Eccl 5:18-19; Deut 28:4
- v3 — Ezek 19:10; Ps 52:8; Prov 5:15-18; Rom 11:24; Gen 49:22
- v5 — Ps 20:2; Ps 134:3; Ps 118:26; Isa 33:20; Ps 122:6
- v6 — Job 42:16; Gen 50:23; Isa 66:12; Ps 125:5; Prov 17:6

Psalm 129

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist recalls how Israel has been greatly oppressed from its youth, yet its enemies have not prevailed against it. He prays that all who hate Zion will be put to shame and wither like grass on a rooftop that dries before it grows.

1	<i>Many a time have they afflicted me from my youth, may Israel now say:</i>	"They have greatly oppressed me from my youth" — let Israel say —
2	<i>Many a time have they afflicted me from my youth: yet they have not prevailed against me.</i>	"they have greatly oppressed me from my youth, but they have not gained the victory over me."
3	<i>The plowers plowed upon my back: they made long their furrows.</i>	Plowmen have plowed my back and made their furrows long.
4	<i>The LORD is righteous: he hath cut asunder the cords of the wicked.</i>	But the LORD is righteous; He has cut me free from the cords of the wicked.
5	<i>Let them all be confounded and turned back that hate Zion.</i>	May all who hate Zion be turned back in shame.
6	<i>Let them be as the grass upon the housetops, which withereth afore it groweth up:</i>	May they be like grass on the roof, which withers before it can grow;

7	<i>Wherewith the mower filleth not his hand; nor he that bindeth sheaves his bosom.</i>	a reaper cannot fill His hands with it, nor one who gathers fill His arms.
8	<i>Neither do they which go by say, The blessing of the LORD be upon you: we bless you in the name of the LORD.</i>	May those who pass by not say to them, "The blessing of the LORD be on You; we bless You in the name of the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 124:1; Hos 11:1; Jer 2:2; Ps 120:1; Ps 122:1
- v2 — Matt 16:18; 2 Cor 4:8-9; Rev 12:8-9; Ps 34:19; John 16:33
- v3 — Isa 51:23
- v4 — Ps 119:137; Lam 3:22; Dan 9:7
- v6 — Ps 37:2
- v7 — Gal 6:8
- v8 — Ruth 2:4; Ps 118:26

Psalm 130

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist cries to the LORD from the depths, pleading for a hearing and confessing that if God kept a record of sins, no one could stand. He places his hope in the LORD's word, waiting for Him more than watchmen wait for the morning, and calls Israel to hope in the LORD's plenteous redemption.

1	<i>Out of the depths have I cried unto thee, O LORD.</i>	Out of the depths I cry to You, LORD;
2	<i>Lord, hear my voice: let thine ears be attentive to the voice of my supplications.</i>	Lord, hear my voice. Let Your ears be attentive to my cry for mercy.
3	<i>If thou, LORD, shouldest mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand?</i>	If You, LORD, kept a record of sins, Lord, who could stand?
4	<i>But there is forgiveness with thee, that thou mayest be feared.</i>	But with You there is forgiveness, so that we can, with reverence, serve You.
5	<i>I wait for the LORD, my soul doth wait, and in his word do I hope.</i>	I wait for the LORD, my whole being waits, and in His word I put my hope.

6	<i>My soul waiteth for the Lord more than they that watch for the morning: I say, more than they that watch for the morning.</i>	I wait for the Lord more than watchmen wait for the morning, more than watchmen wait for the morning.
7	<i>Let Israel hope in the LORD: for with the LORD there is mercy, and with him is plenteous redemption.</i>	Israel, put Your hope in the LORD, for with the LORD is mercy and with Him is full redemption.
8	<i>And he shall redeem Israel from all his iniquities.</i>	He Himself will redeem Israel from all their sins.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 42:7; Heb 5:7; Jonah 2:2-4; Ps 69:14-15; Ps 71:20
- v2 — 2 Chr 6:40; Ps 61:1-2; Neh 1:11; Isa 37:17; Neh 1:6
- v3 — Ps 143:2; Ps 76:7; Rom 3:20-24; John 8:7-9; Rev 6:17
- v4 — Jer 33:8-9; Isa 55:7; Ps 86:5; 1 Kgs 8:39-40; Dan 9:9
- v5 — Isa 30:18; Ps 33:20; Ps 119:81; Ps 62:5; Ps 27:14
- v6 — Ps 119:147; Ps 63:6
- v7 — Eph 1:7-8; Ps 40:3; Rev 5:9; Ps 86:15; Ps 86:5
- v8 — Luke 1:68; Titus 2:14

Psalm 131

A Song of degrees, of David.

David declares that his heart is not proud nor his eyes haughty, and he does not concern himself with great matters beyond him. He has calmed and quieted his soul like a weaned child with its mother, and he calls Israel to hope in the LORD forevermore.

1	<i>LORD, my heart is not haughty, nor mine eyes lofty: neither do I exercise myself in great matters, or in things too high for me.</i>	My heart is not proud, LORD, my eyes are not haughty; I do not concern myself with great matters or things too wonderful for me.
2	<i>Surely I have behaved and quieted myself, as a child that is weaned of his mother: my soul is even as a weaned child.</i>	But I have calmed and quieted myself, I am like a weaned child with its mother; like a weaned child I am content.

3	<i>Let Israel hope in the LORD from henceforth and for ever.</i>	Israel, put Your hope in the LORD both now and forevermore.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 12:16; Ps 139:6; Job 42:3; Ps 101:5; Jer 45:5
- v2 — 1 Cor 14:20; Mark 10:15; Lam 3:26; Ps 43:5; Ps 42:11
- v3 — Ps 130:7; Isa 26:4; Ps 146:5; Jer 17:7-8

Psalm 132

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist recalls David's oath to find a dwelling place for the LORD and pleads with God to remember David's hardships and faithfulness. God in turn swears an oath to David that his descendants will sit on his throne forever, and that He has chosen Zion as His resting place, where He will bless the faithful and clothe the priests with salvation.

1	<i>LORD, remember David, and all his afflictions:</i>	LORD, remember David and all his self-denial.
2	<i>How he sware unto the LORD, and vowed unto the mighty God of Jacob;</i>	He swore an oath to the LORD, He made a vow to the Mighty One of Jacob:
3	<i>Surely I will not come into the tabernacle of my house, nor go up into my bed;</i>	"I will not enter my house or go to my bed,
4	<i>I will not give sleep to mine eyes, or slumber to mine eyelids,</i>	I will allow no sleep to my eyes or slumber to my eyelids,
5	<i>Until I find out a place for the LORD, an habitation for the mighty God of Jacob.</i>	till I find a place for the LORD, a dwelling for the Mighty One of Jacob."
6	<i>Lo, we heard of it at Ephratah: we found it in the fields of the wood.</i>	We heard it in Ephrathah, we came upon it in the fields of Jaar:
7	<i>We will go into his tabernacles: we will worship at his footstool.</i>	"Let us go to His dwelling place, let us worship at His footstool, saying,

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| 8 | <i>Arise, O LORD, into thy rest; thou, and the ark of thy strength.</i> | 'Arise, LORD, and come to Your resting place, You and the ark of Your might. |
| 9 | <i>Let thy priests be clothed with righteousness; and let thy saints shout for joy.</i> | Let Your priests be clothed with righteousness, and let Your saints shout for joy. |
| 10 | <i>For thy servant David's sake turn not away the face of thine anointed.</i> | For your servant David's sake, do not turn away the face of your anointed. |
| 11 | <i>The LORD hath sworn in truth unto David; he will not turn from it; Of the fruit of thy body will I set upon thy throne.</i> | The LORD swore an oath to David, a sure oath he will not abandon: "One of your own descendants I will place on Your throne. |
| 12 | <i>If thy children will keep my covenant and my testimony that I shall teach them, their children shall also sit upon thy throne for evermore.</i> | If Your sons keep my covenant and the statutes I teach them, then their sons will sit on Your throne for ever and ever." |
| 13 | <i>For the LORD hath chosen Zion; he hath desired it for his habitation.</i> | For the LORD has chosen Zion, He has desired it for His dwelling, saying, |
| 14 | <i>This is my rest for ever: here will I dwell; for I have desired it.</i> | "This is my resting place for ever and ever; here I will sit enthroned, for I have desired it. |
| 15 | <i>I will abundantly bless her provision: I will satisfy her poor with bread.</i> | I will bless her with abundant provisions; her poor I will satisfy with food. |
| 16 | <i>I will also clothe her priests with salvation: and her saints shall shout aloud for joy.</i> | I will also clothe her priests with salvation, and her saints shall shout aloud for joy. |
| 17 | <i>There will I make the horn of David to bud: I have ordained a lamp for mine anointed.</i> | There I will make the horn of David to bud; I have ordained a lamp for my anointed. |
| 18 | <i>His enemies will I clothe with shame: but upon himself shall his crown flourish.</i> | I will clothe his enemies with shame, but his crown will be radiant on his head." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 120:1; Ps 129:1; Lam 5:1
- v2 — Gen 49:24
- v5 — Eph 2:22
- v6 — 1 Sam 17:12; 1 Sam 7:1
- v7 — Ps 99:5; Ps 5:7; Lam 2:1
- v11 — 2 Sam 7:12; Acts 2:30; Ps 89:3-4; Ps 110:4; 2 Chr 6:16
- v13 — Ps 78:68-69; Heb 12:22; Ps 87:2; Ps 68:16; Ps 76:1-2
- v14 — Ps 132:8; Ps 87:2; Isa 12:6; 1 Kgs 8:13; Ps 76:2
- v15 — Ps 147:14; Lev 26:4-5; Prov 3:9-10; Mark 8:6-9; 2 Cor 9:10-11
- v16 — 2 Chr 6:41; Ps 132:9
- v17 — Luke 1:69; Ezek 29:21; 2 Chr 21:7; 1 Kgs 11:36; 1 Kgs 15:4
- v18 — Ps 35:26; Job 8:22; Luke 1:32-33; Ps 21:8-9; Matt 28:18

Psalm 133

A Song of degrees, of David.

David declares how good and pleasant it is when brothers dwell together in unity, comparing it to precious oil running down Aaron's beard and to the dew of Hermon falling on the mountains of Zion. There the LORD commands the blessing — life forevermore.

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| 1 | <i>Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity!</i> | How good and pleasant it is when God's people live together in unity! |
| 2 | <i>It is like the precious ointment upon the head, that ran down upon the beard, even Aaron's beard: that went down to the skirts of his garments;</i> | It is like precious oil poured on the head, running down on the beard, running down on Aaron's beard, down on the collar of his robe. |
| 3 | <i>As the dew of Hermon, and as the dew that descended upon the mountains of Zion: for there the LORD commanded the blessing, even life for evermore.</i> | It is as if the dew of Hermon were falling on Mount Zion. For there the LORD bestows His blessing, even life forevermore. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 1:10; 1 Pet 3:8; John 13:35; Heb 13:1; Phil 2:2-5
- v2 — Lev 8:12; Ex 30:25-30; Ex 29:7; Prov 27:9; Ex 39:24

v3 — Deut 28:8; Lev 25:21; Ps 42:8; Deut 4:48; 1 John 5:11

Psalm 134

A Song of degrees.

The psalmist calls the servants of the LORD who stand by night in the house of the LORD to lift up their hands in the sanctuary and bless the LORD. He pronounces a blessing: may the LORD who made heaven and earth bless you from Zion.

1	Behold, bless ye the LORD, all ye servants of the LORD, which by night stand in the house of the LORD.	Praise the LORD, all You servants of the LORD Who minister by night in the house of the LORD.
2	Lift up your hands in the sanctuary, and bless the LORD.	Lift up Your hands in the sanctuary and praise the LORD.
3	The LORD that made heaven and earth bless thee out of Zion.	May the LORD bless You from Zion, He who is the Maker of heaven and earth.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 120:1; 1 Chr 9:33; Ps 135:1-2; Rev 19:5; 2 Chr 29:11
- v2 — Ps 28:2; 1 Tim 2:8; Ps 63:4; Ps 141:2; Lam 3:41
- v3 — Ps 128:5; Ps 20:2; Ps 124:8; Ps 146:5-6; Ps 135:21

Psalm 135

The psalmist calls the servants of the LORD to praise His name, declaring that He does whatever pleases Him in heaven and on earth, in the seas and in the depths. He recounts God's mighty acts in Egypt and against the kings of Canaan, and contrasts the living God with the lifeless idols of the nations.

1	Praise ye the LORD. Praise ye the name of the LORD; praise him, O ye servants of the LORD.	Praise the LORD. Praise the name of the LORD; praise Him, You servants of the LORD,
2	Ye that stand in the house of the LORD, in the courts of the house of our God,	You who minister in the house of the LORD, in the courts of the house of our God.

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| 3 | <i>Praise the LORD; for the LORD is good: sing praises unto his name; for it is pleasant.</i> | Praise the LORD, for the LORD is good; sing praise to His name, for that is pleasant. |
| 4 | <i>For the LORD hath chosen Jacob unto himself, and Israel for his peculiar treasure.</i> | For the LORD has chosen Jacob to be his own, Israel to be his treasured possession. |
| 5 | <i>For I know that the LORD is great, and that our Lord is above all gods.</i> | I know that the LORD is great, that our Lord is greater than all gods. |
| 6 | <i>Whatsoever the LORD pleased, that did he in heaven, and in earth, in the seas, and all deep places.</i> | The LORD does whatever pleases Him, in the heavens and on the earth, in the seas and all their depths. |
| 7 | <i>He causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth; he maketh lightnings for the rain; he bringeth the wind out of his treasures.</i> | He makes clouds rise from the ends of the earth; He sends lightning with the rain and brings out the wind from His storehouses. |
| 8 | <i>Who smote the firstborn of Egypt, both of man and beast.</i> | He struck down the firstborn of Egypt, the firstborn of people and animals. |
| 9 | <i>Who sent tokens and wonders into the midst of thee, O Egypt, upon Pharaoh, and upon all his servants.</i> | He sent his signs and wonders into your midst, Egypt, against Pharaoh and all his servants. |
| 10 | <i>Who smote great nations, and slew mighty kings;</i> | He struck down many nations and killed mighty kings — |
| 11 | <i>Sihon king of the Amorites, and Og king of Bashan, and all the kingdoms of Canaan:</i> | Sihon king of the Amorites, Og king of Bashan, and all the kings of Canaan — |
| 12 | <i>And gave their land for an heritage, an heritage unto Israel his people.</i> | and he gave their land as an inheritance, an inheritance to his people Israel. |
| 13 | <i>Thy name, O LORD, endureth for ever; and thy memorial, O LORD, throughout all generations.</i> | Your name, LORD, endures forever; Your renown, LORD, through all generations. |
| 14 | <i>For the LORD will judge his people, and he will repent himself concerning his servants.</i> | For the LORD will vindicate His people and have compassion on His servants. |

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| 15 <i>The idols of the heathen are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.</i> | The idols of the nations are silver and gold, the work of men's hands. |
| 16 <i>They have mouths, but they speak not; eyes have they, but they see not;</i> | They have mouths, but cannot speak; eyes, but cannot see. |
| 17 <i>They have ears, but they hear not; neither is there any breath in their mouths.</i> | They have ears, but cannot hear; nor is there breath in their mouths. |
| 18 <i>They that make them are like unto them: so is every one that trusteth in them.</i> | Those who make them will be like them, and so will all who trust in them. |
| 19 <i>Bless the LORD, O house of Israel: bless the LORD, O house of Aaron:</i> | All You Israelites, praise the LORD; house of Aaron, praise the LORD; |
| 20 <i>Bless the LORD, O house of Levi: ye that fear the LORD, bless the LORD.</i> | house of Levi, praise the LORD; You who fear Him, praise the LORD. |
| 21 <i>Blessed be the LORD out of Zion, which dwelleth at Jerusalem. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | Praise be to the LORD from Zion, to Him who dwells in Jerusalem. Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 96:1-4; Ps 7:17; Ps 33:1-2; Ps 111:1; Ps 148:13
v2 — Ps 116:19
v3 — Ps 147:1; Ps 119:68; Ps 33:1; Ps 106:1; Matt 19:17
v4 — 1 Pet 2:9; Deut 10:15; Mal 3:17; Deut 7:6-7
v5 — Ps 95:3; Deut 10:17; Ps 97:9; Ps 48:1; Dan 6:26-27
v6 — Dan 4:35; Ps 115:3; Matt 28:18; Matt 8:26-27; Isa 46:10
v7 — Jer 10:13; Jer 51:16; Job 28:25-26; Zech 10:1
v8 — Ps 78:51
v12 — Ps 78:55
v13 — Ps 102:12; Ex 3:15
v14 — Deut 32:36
v15 — Ps 115:4-8; Acts 17:29; Hab 2:18-19; Isa 37:19; Jer 10:3-11

Psalm 136

The psalmist gives thanks to the LORD in twenty-six verses, each ending with the refrain that His mercy endures forever. He praises God for creation, the exodus, the conquest of Canaan,

and His care for His people in their low estate.

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| 1 <i>O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the LORD, for He is good. His mercy endures forever. |
| 2 <i>O give thanks unto the God of gods: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the God of gods. His mercy endures forever. |
| 3 <i>O give thanks to the Lord of lords: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the Lord of lords. His mercy endures forever. |
| 4 <i>To him who alone doeth great wonders: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | To Him who alone does great wonders, His mercy endures forever. |
| 5 <i>To him that by wisdom made the heavens: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Who by His understanding made the heavens, His mercy endures forever. |
| 6 <i>To him that stretched out the earth above the waters: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Who spread out the earth upon the waters, His mercy endures forever. |
| 7 <i>To him that made great lights: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | Who made the great lights — his mercy endures forever. |
| 8 <i>The sun to rule by day: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | The sun to govern the day, His mercy endures forever. |
| 9 <i>The moon and stars to rule by night: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | The moon and stars to govern the night; His mercy endures forever. |
| 10 <i>To him that smote Egypt in their firstborn: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | To Him who struck down the firstborn of Egypt, His mercy endures forever. |
| 11 <i>And brought out Israel from among them: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | And brought Israel out from among them, His mercy endures forever. |
| 12 <i>With a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | With a mighty hand and outstretched arm; His mercy endures forever. |
| 13 <i>To him which divided the Red sea into parts: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | To Him who divided the Red Sea asunder, His mercy endures forever. |

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| 14 <i>And made Israel to pass through the midst of it: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | And brought Israel through the midst of it, His mercy endures forever. |
| 15 <i>But overthrew Pharaoh and his host in the Red sea: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | But swept Pharaoh and his army into the Red Sea; his mercy endures forever. |
| 16 <i>To him which led his people through the wilderness: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | To him who led his people through the wilderness; his mercy endures forever. |
| 17 <i>To him which smote great kings: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | To him who struck down great kings, his mercy endures forever. |
| 18 <i>And slew famous kings: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | And killed mighty kings — his mercy endures forever. |
| 19 <i>Sihon king of the Amorites: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | Sihon king of the Amorites, his mercy endures forever. |
| 20 <i>And Og the king of Bashan: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | And Og king of Bashan — his mercy endures forever. |
| 21 <i>And gave their land for an heritage: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | And gave their land as an inheritance, his mercy endures forever. |
| 22 <i>Even an heritage unto Israel his servant: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | An inheritance to his servant Israel; his mercy endures forever. |
| 23 <i>Who remembered us in our low estate: for his mercy endureth for ever:</i> | He remembered us in our low condition, his mercy endures forever. |
| 24 <i>And hath redeemed us from our enemies: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | And freed us from our enemies. His mercy endures forever. |
| 25 <i>Who giveth food to all flesh: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | He gives food to every creature. His mercy endures forever. |
| 26 <i>O give thanks unto the God of heaven: for his mercy endureth for ever.</i> | Give thanks to the God of heaven. His mercy endures forever. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 118:1; 1 Chr 16:41; Ps 106:1; Ps 107:1
- v2 — Deut 10:17; Ps 97:9
- v4 — Ps 72:18; Job 5:9; Ps 86:10; Ex 15:11; Rev 15:3
- v5 — Gen 1:1; Ps 104:24
- v6 — Ps 24:2; Gen 1:9; Jer 10:12; Job 26:7; Ps 104:2-3
- v10 — Ex 12:29; Ps 78:51
- v11 — Ex 12:51; Ex 13:3
- v12 — Jer 32:21
- v13 — Ps 78:13
- v23 — Isa 63:9; Luke 1:48; Ps 142:6; Ps 113:7; Ps 116:6
- v25 — Ps 145:15; Ps 104:27
- v26 — Ps 136:1-3

Psalm 137

The exiles weep by the rivers of Babylon, unable to sing the songs of Zion in a foreign land while their captors taunt them for a song. The psalmist vows never to forget Jerusalem and pronounces a fierce blessing on the one who repays Babylon for what she did to Israel.

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| 1 | <i>By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat
down, yea, we wept, when we
remembered Zion.</i> | By the rivers of Babylon we sat and
wept when we remembered Zion. |
| 2 | <i>We hanged our harps upon the
willows in the midst thereof.</i> | There on the poplars we hung our
harps, |
| 3 | <i>For there they that carried us away
captive required of us a song; and
they that wasted us required of us
mirth, saying, Sing us one of the songs
of Zion.</i> | for there our captors asked us for
songs, our tormentors demanded songs
of joy; they said, "Sing us one of the
songs of Zion!" |
| 4 | <i>How shall we sing the LORD'S song
in a strange land?</i> | How can we sing the songs of the
LORD while in a foreign land? |
| 5 | <i>If I forget thee, O Jerusalem, let my
right hand forget her cunning.</i> | If I forget You, Jerusalem, may my
right hand forget its skill. |

6	<i>If I do not remember thee, let my tongue cleave to the roof of my mouth; if I prefer not Jerusalem above my chief joy.</i>	May my tongue cling to the roof of my mouth if I do not remember You, if I do not consider Jerusalem my highest joy.
7	<i>Remember, O LORD, the children of Edom in the day of Jerusalem; who said, Rase it, rase it, even to the foundation thereof.</i>	Remember, LORD, what the Edomites did on the day Jerusalem fell. "Tear it down," they cried, "tear it down to its foundations!"
8	<i>O daughter of Babylon, who art to be destroyed; happy shall he be, that rewardeth thee as thou hast served us.</i>	O daughter of Babylon, who are to be destroyed, happy shall He be who rewards you as you have served us.
9	<i>Happy shall he be, that taketh and dasheth thy little ones against the stones.</i>	Blessed is the one who seizes your infants and dashes them against the rocks.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 1:1; Ezek 3:15
- v3 — Luke 21:6
- v4 — Amos 8:3; Isa 22:12; Hos 9:4
- v6 — Ezek 3:26; Ps 22:15
- v7 — Lam 4:21-22; Jer 49:7-22; Obad 1:10-14; Ezek 25:12-14; Ps 74:18
- v8 — Rev 18:6; Jer 25:12-14; Isa 14:4-24
- v9 — Isa 13:16; Nah 3:10; Hos 13:16; 2 Kgs 8:12; Hos 10:14

Psalm 138

A Psalm of David.

David praises the LORD with his whole heart before the gods, giving thanks for His lovingkindness and truth, declaring that God has magnified His word above all His name. He trusts that though he walks in the midst of trouble, the LORD will stretch out His hand against his enemies and complete what He has begun.

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| 1 | <i>I will praise thee with my whole heart: before the gods will I sing praise unto thee.</i> | I will praise You, LORD, with all my heart; before the gods I will sing Your praise. |
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| <p>2 <i>I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word above all thy name.</i></p> <p>3 <i>In the day when I cried thou answeredst me, and strengthenedst me with strength in my soul.</i></p> <p>4 <i>All the kings of the earth shall praise thee, O LORD, when they hear the words of thy mouth.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Yea, they shall sing in the ways of the LORD: for great is the glory of the LORD.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Though the LORD be high, yet hath he respect unto the lowly: but the proud he knoweth afar off.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Though I walk in the midst of trouble, thou wilt revive me: thou shalt stretch forth thine hand against the wrath of mine enemies, and thy right hand shall save me.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The LORD will perfect that which concerneth me: thy mercy, O LORD, endureth for ever: forsake not the works of thine own hands.</i></p> | <p>I will worship toward Your holy temple, and praise Your name for Your lovingkindness and for Your truth, for You have magnified Your word above all Your name.</p> <p>When I called, You answered me; You greatly emboldened me.</p> <p>May all the kings of the earth praise You, LORD, when they hear what You have decreed.</p> <p>May they sing of the ways of the LORD, for the glory of the LORD is great.</p> <p>Though the LORD is exalted, He looks kindly on the lowly; though lofty, He sees them from afar.</p> <p>Though I walk in the midst of trouble, You preserve my life. You stretch out Your hand against the anger of my foes; with Your right hand You save me.</p> <p>The LORD will perfect that which concerns me; Your mercy, O LORD, endures forever; do not forsake the works of Your own hands.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 111:1; Ps 95:3; 1 Cor 14:15
- v2 — Matt 5:18; Ps 56:10; Isa 42:21; Matt 24:35; Ps 56:4
- v3 — 1 Pet 5:10; Ps 18:6; Ps 34:4-6; Zech 10:12; Isa 40:29-31
- v4 — Ps 102:15; Ps 72:11
- v5 — Rev 4:11; Ps 21:5; Rev 7:12; Mal 1:11; Rev 5:12-14
- v6 — Ps 113:5-6; 1 Sam 2:7-8; Isa 57:15; Prov 3:34; Jas 4:6

v7 — Isa 41:10; Ps 23:3-4; Ps 71:20-21; Ps 85:6; Acts 2:33

v8 — Phil 1:6; Ps 57:2; 1 Thess 5:24; Isa 26:12; Ps 136:1

Psalm 139

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

David marvels at God's complete knowledge of him — every thought, every word, every movement known before it happens — and at God's inescapable presence in the heights of heaven, the depths of hell, and the farthest sea. He praises the LORD for forming him in his mother's womb, and asks God to search his heart and lead him in the everlasting way.

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| 1 | <i>O LORD, thou hast searched me, and known me.</i> | You have searched me, LORD, and You know me. |
| 2 | <i>Thou knowest my downsitting and mine uprising, thou understandest my thought afar off.</i> | You know when I sit and when I rise; You perceive my thoughts from far away. |
| 3 | <i>Thou compassest my path and my lying down, and art acquainted with all my ways.</i> | You discern my going out and my lying down; You are familiar with all my ways. |
| 4 | <i>For there is not a word in my tongue, but, lo, O LORD, thou knowest it altogether.</i> | Before a word is on my tongue You, LORD, know it completely. |
| 5 | <i>Thou hast beset me behind and before, and laid thine hand upon me.</i> | You hem me in behind and before, and You lay Your hand upon me. |
| 6 | <i>Such knowledge is too wonderful for me; it is high, I cannot attain unto it.</i> | Such knowledge is too wonderful for me, too lofty for me to attain. |
| 7 | <i>Whither shall I go from thy spirit? or whither shall I flee from thy presence?</i> | Where can I go from Your Spirit? Where can I flee from Your presence? |
| 8 | <i>If I ascend up into heaven, thou art there: if I make my bed in hell, behold, thou art there.</i> | If I go up to the heavens, You are there; if I make my bed in hell, You are there. |
| 9 | <i>If I take the wings of the morning, and dwell in the uttermost parts of the sea;</i> | If I rise on the wings of the dawn, if I settle on the far side of the sea, |
| 10 | <i>Even there shall thy hand lead me, and thy right hand shall hold me.</i> | even there Your hand will guide me, Your right hand will hold me fast. |

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| 11 <i>If I say, Surely the darkness shall cover me; even the night shall be light about me.</i> | If I say, "Surely the darkness will hide me and the light become night around me," |
| 12 <i>Yea, the darkness hideth not from thee; but the night shineth as the day: the darkness and the light are both alike to thee.</i> | even the darkness will not be dark to You; the night will shine like the day, for darkness is as light to You. |
| 13 <i>For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb.</i> | For You created my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. |
| 14 <i>I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.</i> | I praise You because I am fearfully and wonderfully made; Your works are wonderful, I know that full well. |
| 15 <i>My substance was not hid from thee, when I was made in secret, and curiously wrought in the lowest parts of the earth.</i> | My frame was not hidden from You when I was made in the secret place, when I was woven together in the depths of the earth. |
| 16 <i>Thine eyes did see my substance, yet being unperfect; and in thy book all my members were written, which in continuance were fashioned, when as yet there was none of them.</i> | Your eyes saw my unformed body; all the days ordained for me were written in Your book before one of them came to be. |
| 17 <i>How precious also are thy thoughts unto me, O God! how great is the sum of them!</i> | How precious to me are Your thoughts, God! How vast is the sum of them! |
| 18 <i>If I should count them, they are more in number than the sand: when I awake, I am still with thee.</i> | Were I to count them, they would outnumber the grains of sand — when I awake, I am still with You. |
| 19 <i>Surely thou wilt slay the wicked, O God: depart from me therefore, ye bloody men.</i> | If only You, God, would slay the wicked! Away from me, you who are bloodthirsty! |

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| 20 | <i>For they speak against thee wickedly, and thine enemies take thy name in vain.</i> | They speak of you with evil intent; your adversaries misuse your name. |
| 21 | <i>Do not I hate them, O LORD, that hate thee? and am not I grieved with those that rise up against thee?</i> | Do I not hate those who hate You, LORD, and abhor those who are in rebellion against You? |
| 22 | <i>I hate them with perfect hatred: I count them mine enemies.</i> | I have nothing but hatred for them; I count them my enemies. |
| 23 | <i>Search me, O God, and know my heart: try me, and know my thoughts:</i> | Search me, God, and know my heart; test me and know my anxious thoughts. |
| 24 | <i>And see if there be any wicked way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.</i> | See if there is any offensive way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 4:13; Jer 12:3; Jer 17:9-10; Ps 44:21; Ps 17:3
v2 — Matt 9:4; 2 Kgs 19:27; Isa 37:28; Luke 9:47; John 2:24-25
v6 — Rom 11:33; Job 42:3; Ps 40:5; Job 26:14; Job 11:7-9
v7 — Jer 23:23-24; Jonah 1:3; Jonah 1:10
v8 — Amos 9:2-4; Job 34:21-22; Jonah 2:2; Obad 1:4; Prov 15:11
v10 — Ps 23:3; Isa 41:13; Ps 73:23; Ps 63:8; Ps 143:9-10
v13 — Jer 1:5; Ps 119:73; Isa 44:2; Job 31:15; Job 10:9-12
v14 — Gen 1:26-27; Ps 111:2; Ps 104:24; Ps 92:4-5; Job 5:9
v16 — Ps 56:8; Mal 3:16; Rev 20:12
v17 — Ps 40:5; Jer 29:11; Isa 55:8-9; Ps 92:5; Ps 36:7
v23 — Ps 26:2; Job 31:6; 1 Pet 1:7; Prov 17:3; Deut 8:2
v24 — Ps 143:10; Jer 17:9-10; Ps 25:8-9; Ps 119:32; Ps 16:11

Psalm 140

To the chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

David pleads with the LORD to rescue him from violent and evil men who sharpen their tongues like serpents and plot his downfall. He trusts that the LORD upholds the cause of the afflicted and the rights of the poor, and prays that the mischief of the wicked falls back on their own heads.

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| 1 | <i>Deliver me, O LORD, from the evil man; preserve me from the violent man;</i> | Rescue me, LORD, from evildoers; protect me from the violent, |
| 2 | <i>Which imagine mischiefs in their heart; continually are they gathered together for war.</i> | who devise evil plans in their hearts and stir up war every day. |
| 3 | <i>They have sharpened their tongues like a serpent; adders' poison is under their lips. Selah.</i> | They make their tongues as sharp as a serpent's; the poison of vipers is on their lips. |
| 4 | <i>Keep me, O LORD, from the hands of the wicked; preserve me from the violent man; who have purposed to overthrow my goings.</i> | Keep me safe, LORD, from the hands of the wicked; protect me from the violent, who devise ways to trip my feet. |
| 5 | <i>The proud have hid a snare for me, and cords; they have spread a net by the wayside; they have set gins for me. Selah.</i> | The arrogant have hidden a snare for me; they have spread out the cords of their net and set traps for me along my path. |
| 6 | <i>I said unto the LORD, Thou art my God: hear the voice of my supplications, O LORD.</i> | I say to the LORD, "You are my God." Hear, LORD, my cry for mercy. |
| 7 | <i>O GOD the Lord, the strength of my salvation, thou hast covered my head in the day of battle.</i> | O GOD the Lord, the strength of my salvation, You have covered my head in the day of battle. |
| 8 | <i>Grant not, O LORD, the desires of the wicked: further not his wicked device; lest they exalt themselves. Selah.</i> | Do not grant the wicked their desires, LORD; do not let their plans succeed, or they will become proud. |
| 9 | <i>As for the head of those that compass me about, let the mischief of their own lips cover them.</i> | May the heads of those who surround me be covered with the trouble their lips have caused. |
| 10 | <i>Let burning coals fall upon them: let them be cast into the fire; into deep pits, that they rise not up again.</i> | May burning coals fall on them; may they be thrown into the fire, into miry pits, never to rise. |

11	<i>Let not an evil speaker be established in the earth: evil shall hunt the violent man to overthrow him.</i>	May slanderers not be established in the land; may disaster hunt down the violent.
12	<i>I know that the LORD will maintain the cause of the afflicted, and the right of the poor.</i>	I know that the LORD secures justice for the poor and upholds the cause of the needy.
13	<i>Surely the righteous shall give thanks unto thy name: the upright shall dwell in thy presence.</i>	Surely the righteous will praise your name, and the upright will live in Your presence.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 18:48; Ps 140:4; Ps 71:4; Hab 1:2-3; Ps 17:13
- v2 — Ps 56:6; Ps 36:4; Ps 64:5-6
- v3 — Ps 58:4; Rom 3:13-14; 2 Cor 11:3; Prov 23:32
- v4 — Ps 36:11; Ps 71:4; Ps 17:5
- v5 — Ps 35:7; Ps 142:3; Jer 18:22
- v6 — Ps 31:14; Ps 16:2; Ps 142:5; Ps 119:57
- v7 — Ps 62:7; Ps 89:26; Ps 18:1-2; Deut 33:27-29; Ps 62:2
- v8 — Ps 10:2-3; Job 5:12-13; Deut 32:27; 2 Sam 15:31; Ps 27:12
- v9 — Ps 7:16; Prov 18:7
- v10 — Ps 11:6; Ps 21:9
- v12 — Ps 9:4; 1 Kgs 8:49; Prov 23:10-11; 1 Kgs 8:45; Jer 22:16
- v13 — Ps 16:11; Ps 11:7; 1 Thess 4:17; Isa 3:10; John 17:24

Psalm 141

A Psalm of David.

David prays that his words and worship would rise before God like incense, asking the LORD to set a guard over his mouth and keep his heart from evil. He would rather be rebuked by the righteous than anointed by the wicked, and he looks to the LORD alone as his refuge.

1	<i>LORD, I cry unto thee: make haste unto me; give ear unto my voice, when I cry unto thee.</i>	I call to You, LORD, come quickly to me; hear me when I call to You.
2	<i>Let my prayer be set forth before thee as incense; and the lifting up of my hands as the evening sacrifice.</i>	May my prayer be set before You like incense; may the lifting up of my hands be like the evening sacrifice.

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| 3 | <i>Set a watch, O LORD, before my mouth; keep the door of my lips.</i> | Set a guard over my mouth, LORD; keep watch over the door of my lips. |
| 4 | <i>Incline not my heart to any evil thing, to practise wicked works with men that work iniquity: and let me not eat of their dainties.</i> | Do not let my heart be drawn to what is evil so that I take part in wicked deeds along with those who are evildoers; do not let me eat their delicacies. |
| 5 | <i>Let the righteous smite me; it shall be a kindness: and let him reprove me; it shall be an excellent oil, which shall not break my head: for yet my prayer also shall be in their calamities.</i> | Let a righteous man strike me — that is a kindness; let Him rebuke me — that is oil on my head. My head will not refuse it, for my prayer will still be against the deeds of evildoers. |
| 6 | <i>When their judges are overthrown in stony places, they shall hear my words; for they are sweet.</i> | Their rulers will be thrown down from the cliffs, and the wicked will learn that my words were well spoken. |
| 7 | <i>Our bones are scattered at the grave's mouth, as when one cutteth and cleaveth wood upon the earth.</i> | They will say, "As one plows and breaks up the earth, so our bones have been scattered at the mouth of the grave." |
| 8 | <i>But mine eyes are unto thee, O GOD the Lord: in thee is my trust; leave not my soul destitute.</i> | But my eyes are to You, O GOD the Lord; in You is my trust; leave not my soul destitute. |
| 9 | <i>Keep me from the snares which they have laid for me, and the gins of the workers of iniquity.</i> | Keep me safe from the traps set by evildoers, from the snares they have laid for me. |
| 10 | <i>Let the wicked fall into their own nets, whilst that I withal escape.</i> | Let the wicked fall into their own nets, while I pass by in safety. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 70:5; Ps 40:13; Ps 71:12; Ps 69:17-18; Ps 143:7

v2 — Rev 8:3-4; Rev 5:8; 1 Tim 2:8; Mal 1:11; Dan 9:21

v3 — Jas 1:26; Ps 39:1; Mic 7:5; Ps 34:13; Jas 3:2

v4 — Matt 6:13; Ps 119:36; 2 Cor 6:17; 1 Cor 15:33; Isa 63:17

v5 — Eccl 7:5; Rev 3:19; Gal 6:1; Prov 27:5-6; Prov 25:12

v7 — Ps 53:5
v8 — Ps 123:1-2; 2 Chr 20:12; Isa 41:17; Ps 102:17; Ps 25:15-17
v9 — Ps 140:5; Ps 119:110; Luke 20:20; Prov 13:14; Ps 38:12
v10 — Ps 35:8; Ps 140:9; Ps 7:15-16; Prov 11:8; Ps 64:7-8

Psalm 142

Maschil of David; A Prayer when he was in the cave.

David, praying from a cave, pours out his complaint before the LORD, declaring that no one cares for his soul and there is no refuge left. He cries out to God as his only portion in the land of the living, trusting that the LORD will deal bountifully with him.

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| 1 | <i>I cried unto the LORD with my voice; with my voice unto the LORD did I make my supplication.</i> | I cry aloud to the LORD; I lift up my voice to the LORD for mercy. |
| 2 | <i>I poured out my complaint before him; I shewed before him my trouble.</i> | I pour out before Him my complaint; before Him I tell my trouble. |
| 3 | <i>When my spirit was overwhelmed within me, then thou knewest my path. In the way wherein I walked have they privily laid a snare for me.</i> | When my spirit grows faint within me, it is You who watch over my way. In the path where I walk people have hidden a snare for me. |
| 4 | <i>I looked on my right hand, and beheld, but there was no man that would know me: refuge failed me; no man cared for my soul.</i> | Look and see, there is no one at my right hand; no one is concerned for me. I have no refuge; no one cares for my life. |
| 5 | <i>I cried unto thee, O LORD: I said, Thou art my refuge and my portion in the land of the living.</i> | I cry to You, LORD; I say, "You are my refuge, my portion in the land of the living." |
| 6 | <i>Attend unto my cry; for I am brought very low: deliver me from my persecutors; for they are stronger than I.</i> | Listen to my cry, for I am in desperate need; rescue me from those who pursue me, for they are too strong for me. |
| 7 | <i>Bring my soul out of prison, that I may praise thy name: the righteous shall compass me about; for thou shalt deal bountifully with me.</i> | Set me free from my prison, that I may praise Your name. Then the righteous will gather about me because of your goodness to me. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 57:1; Ps 30:8; Ps 141:1; Ps 77:1-2; 1 Sam 24:3
- v2 — Rom 8:26; Isa 26:16; Phil 4:6-7; Ps 62:8; Heb 5:7
- v3 — Ps 140:5; Ps 141:9; Ps 143:4; Ps 61:2; Mark 14:33-36
- v4 — Jer 30:17; Ps 88:18; Ps 31:11; Matt 26:56; Job 19:13-19
- v5 — 2 Tim 4:17; Ps 16:5; Ps 27:13; Lam 3:24; Ps 73:26
- v6 — Ps 79:8
- v7 — Ps 143:11; Ps 146:7; Ps 7:6-7; Ps 13:6; Acts 2:24

Psalm 143

A Psalm of David.

David pleads with the LORD to hear his prayer and not enter into judgment with him, for no living person is righteous before God. Crushed by enemies and overwhelmed in spirit, he remembers God's past works, stretches out his hands, and asks to be taught God's will and led on level ground.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear my prayer, O LORD, give ear to my supplications: in thy faithfulness answer me, and in thy righteousness.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And enter not into judgment with thy servant: for in thy sight shall no man living be justified.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath smitten my life down to the ground; he hath made me to dwell in darkness, as those that have been long dead.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Therefore is my spirit overwhelmed within me; my heart within me is desolate.</i></p> <p>5 <i>I remember the days of old; I meditate on all thy works; I muse on the work of thy hands.</i></p> | <p>LORD, hear my prayer, listen to my cry for mercy; in Your faithfulness and righteousness come to my relief.</p> <p>Do not bring Your servant into judgment, for no one living is righteous before you.</p> <p>The enemy pursues me, he crushes me to the ground; He makes me dwell in the darkness like those long dead.</p> <p>So my spirit grows faint within me; my heart within me is dismayed.</p> <p>I remember the days of long ago; I meditate on all Your works and consider what Your hands have done.</p> |
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| <p>6 <i>I stretch forth my hands unto thee: my soul thirsteth after thee, as a thirsty land. Selah.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Hear me speedily, O LORD: my spirit faileth: hide not thy face from me, lest I be like unto them that go down into the pit.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Cause me to hear thy lovingkindness in the morning; for in thee do I trust: cause me to know the way wherein I should walk; for I lift up my soul unto thee.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Deliver me, O LORD, from mine enemies: I flee unto thee to hide me.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Teach me to do thy will; for thou art my God: thy spirit is good; lead me into the land of uprightness.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Quicken me, O LORD, for thy name's sake: for thy righteousness' sake bring my soul out of trouble.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And of thy mercy cut off mine enemies, and destroy all them that afflict my soul: for I am thy servant.</i></p> | <p>I spread out my hands to You; I thirst for You like a parched land.</p> <p>Answer me quickly, LORD; my spirit fails. Do not hide Your face from me or I will be like those who go down to the pit.</p> <p>Cause me to hear Your lovingkindness in the morning, for in You do I trust; cause me to know the way in which I should walk, for I lift up my soul to You.</p> <p>Rescue me from my enemies, LORD, for I hide myself in You.</p> <p>Teach me to do Your will, for You are my God; may Your good Spirit lead me on level ground.</p> <p>For Your name's sake, LORD, preserve my life; in Your righteousness, bring me out of trouble.</p> <p>And of Your mercy cut off my enemies, and destroy all those who afflict my soul, for I am Your servant.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 71:2; Ps 31:1; Ps 140:6; Dan 9:16; 1 John 1:9
- v2** — Eccl 7:20; Job 25:4; Rom 3:20; Ps 130:3; 1 John 1:10
- v3** — Lam 3:6; Ps 7:5; Ps 7:1-2; 2 Sam 2:22; Ps 142:6
- v5** — Ps 77:10-12; Ps 77:5-6; 1 Sam 17:45-50; Mic 6:5; Ps 111:4
- v6** — Ps 63:1; Job 11:13; Ps 88:9; Ps 84:2; Ps 42:1-2
- v7** — Ps 69:17; Ps 28:1; Ps 27:9; Ps 71:12
- v8** — Ps 25:4-5; Prov 3:5-6; Ps 32:8; Isa 48:17; Isa 30:21
- v9** — Prov 18:10; Ps 61:3-4
- v10** — Ps 25:4-5; John 14:26; Heb 13:21; Ps 23:3; Ps 119:12
- v11** — Ps 31:1; Eph 2:4-5; Ps 119:25; Ps 71:2

v12 — Ps 54:5; Ps 116:16; Ps 119:94

Psalm 144

A Psalm of David.

David blesses the LORD as his Rock who trains his hands for war, his fortress and deliverer, and he marvels that God pays attention to mortal man who is like a breath. He asks God to part the heavens and come down, to rescue him from enemies, and prays for a blessed nation whose God is the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>Blessed be the LORD my strength,
which teacheth my hands to war, and
my fingers to fight:</i> | Praise be to the LORD my Rock, who
trains my hands for war, my fingers for
battle. |
| 2 | <i>My goodness, and my fortress; my
high tower, and my deliverer; my
shield, and he in whom I trust; who
subdueth my people under me.</i> | He is my loving God and my fortress,
my stronghold and my deliverer, my
shield, in whom I take refuge, who
subdues peoples under me. |
| 3 | <i>LORD, what is man, that thou takest
knowledge of him! or the son of man,
that thou makest account of him!</i> | LORD, what is man, that You take
knowledge of Him? Or the son of man,
that You make account of Him? |
| 4 | <i>Man is like to vanity: his days are as a
shadow that passeth away.</i> | They are like a breath; their days are
like a fleeting shadow. |
| 5 | <i>Bow thy heavens, O LORD, and come
down: touch the mountains, and they
shall smoke.</i> | Part Your heavens, LORD, and come
down; touch the mountains, so that
they smoke. |
| 6 | <i>Send thine lightnings, and scatter
them: shoot out thine arrows, and
destroy them.</i> | Send forth lightning and scatter the
enemy; shoot your arrows and rout
them. |
| 7 | <i>Send thine hand from above; rid me,
and deliver me out of great waters,
from the hand of strange children;</i> | Reach down Your hand from on high;
deliver me and rescue me from the
mighty waters, from the hands of
foreigners |
| 8 | <i>Whose mouth speaketh vanity, and
their right hand is a right hand of
falsehood.</i> | whose mouths are full of lies, whose
right hands are deceitful. |

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| <p>9 <i>I will sing a new song unto thee, O God: upon a psaltery and an instrument of ten strings will I sing praises unto thee.</i></p> <p>10 <i>It is he that giveth salvation unto kings: who delivereth David his servant from the hurtful sword.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Rid me, and deliver me from the hand of strange children, whose mouth speaketh vanity, and their right hand is a right hand of falsehood:</i></p> <p>12 <i>That our sons may be as plants grown up in their youth; that our daughters may be as corner stones, polished after the similitude of a palace:</i></p> <p>13 <i>That our garners may be full, affording all manner of store: that our sheep may bring forth thousands and ten thousands in our streets:</i></p> <p>14 <i>That our oxen may be strong to labour; that there be no breaking in, nor going out; that there be no complaining in our streets.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Happy is that people, that is in such a case: yea, happy is that people, whose God is the LORD.</i></p> | <p>I will sing a new song to You, my God; on the ten-stringed lyre I will make music to You,</p> <p>to the One who gives victory to kings, who delivers his servant David.</p> <p>From the deadly sword deliver me; rescue me from the hands of foreigners whose mouths are full of lies, whose right hands are deceitful.</p> <p>Then our sons in their youth will be like well-nurtured plants, and our daughters will be like pillars carved to adorn a palace.</p> <p>Our barns will be filled with every kind of provision. Our sheep will increase by thousands, by tens of thousands in our fields;</p> <p>our oxen will draw heavy loads. There will be no breaching of walls, no going into captivity, no cry of distress in our streets.</p> <p>Blessed is the people of whom this is true; blessed is the people whose God is the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 18:34; 2 Sam 22:35; Ps 18:2; Ps 44:3-4; Eph 6:10-11
- v2** — 2 Sam 22:2-3; Ps 18:2; Ps 91:2; Ps 59:9
- v3** — Ps 8:4; Job 7:17; Heb 2:6; Job 15:14; Ps 146:3-4
- v4** — Ps 102:11; Job 8:9; Ps 109:23; Ps 39:5-6
- v5** — Ps 104:32; Ps 18:9
- v6** — Deut 32:23; Ps 18:13-14

- v7 — Ps 18:16; Ps 69:1-2
- v9 — Ps 33:2-3; Ps 40:3
- v10 — Ps 18:50; Ps 140:7; Ps 33:16-18
- v12 — Ps 128:3; 1 Pet 3:3-6; Isa 44:3-5; Ps 115:14-15; Job 42:15
- v13 — Deut 7:13-14; Deut 28:4; Deut 28:8; Lev 26:10
- v15 — Ps 33:12; Eph 1:3; Ps 146:5; Deut 33:29; Ps 65:4

Psalm 145

David's Psalm of praise.

David exalts the LORD as King, declaring His greatness unsearchable and His mighty acts worthy of praise from one generation to the next. The LORD is gracious, merciful, longsuffering, good to all, faithful in all His words, and near to all who call on Him in truth.

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| 1 | <i>I will extol thee, my God, O king; and I will bless thy name for ever and ever.</i> | I will exalt You, my God the King; I will praise your name for ever and ever. |
| 2 | <i>Every day will I bless thee; and I will praise thy name for ever and ever.</i> | Every day I will praise you and extol your name for ever and ever. |
| 3 | <i>Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised; and his greatness is unsearchable.</i> | Great is the LORD and most worthy of praise; His greatness no one can fathom. |
| 4 | <i>One generation shall praise thy works to another, and shall declare thy mighty acts.</i> | One generation commends Your works to another; they tell of Your mighty acts. |
| 5 | <i>I will speak of the glorious honour of thy majesty, and of thy wondrous works.</i> | They speak of the glorious splendor of Your majesty — and I will meditate on Your wonderful works. |
| 6 | <i>And men shall speak of the might of thy terrible acts: and I will declare thy greatness.</i> | They tell of the power of Your awesome works — and I will proclaim Your great deeds. |
| 7 | <i>They shall abundantly utter the memory of thy great goodness, and shall sing of thy righteousness.</i> | They celebrate Your abundant goodness and joyfully sing of Your righteousness. |
| 8 | <i>The LORD is gracious, and full of compassion; slow to anger, and of great mercy.</i> | The LORD is gracious and full of compassion, longsuffering, and of great mercy. |

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| 9 | <i>The LORD is good to all: and his tender mercies are over all his works.</i> | The LORD is good to all; He has compassion on all He has made. |
| 10 | <i>All thy works shall praise thee, O LORD; and thy saints shall bless thee.</i> | All Your works shall praise You, O LORD; and Your saints shall bless You. |
| 11 | <i>They shall speak of the glory of thy kingdom, and talk of thy power;</i> | They shall speak of the glory of Your kingdom, and talk of Your power, |
| 12 | <i>To make known to the sons of men his mighty acts, and the glorious majesty of his kingdom.</i> | to make known to the sons of men His mighty acts, and the glorious majesty of His kingdom. |
| 13 | <i>Thy kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and thy dominion endureth throughout all generations.</i> | Your kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and Your dominion endures throughout all generations. |
| 14 | <i>The LORD upholdeth all that fall, and raiseth up all those that be bowed down.</i> | The LORD upholds all who fall and lifts up all who are bowed down. |
| 15 | <i>The eyes of all wait upon thee; and thou givest them their meat in due season.</i> | The eyes of all look to You, and You give them their food at the proper time. |
| 16 | <i>Thou openest thine hand, and satisfiest the desire of every living thing.</i> | You open Your hand and satisfy the desires of every living thing. |
| 17 | <i>The LORD is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works.</i> | The LORD is righteous in all His ways, and holy in all His works. |
| 18 | <i>The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.</i> | The LORD is near to all who call on Him, to all who call on Him in truth. |
| 19 | <i>He will fulfil the desire of them that fear him: he also will hear their cry, and will save them.</i> | He fulfills the desires of those who fear Him; He hears their cry and saves them. |
| 20 | <i>The LORD preserveth all them that love him: but all the wicked will he destroy.</i> | The LORD watches over all who love Him, but all the wicked he will destroy. |

21	<i>My mouth shall speak the praise of the LORD: and let all flesh bless his holy name for ever and ever.</i>	My mouth will speak in praise of the LORD. Let every creature praise His holy name for ever and ever.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 47:6-8; Ps 34:1; Ps 45:6; Matt 25:34; Ps 30:12
- v3 — Ps 147:5; Rom 11:33; Job 5:9; Isa 40:28; Job 9:10
- v4 — Ps 71:18; Ps 78:3-7; Deut 6:7; Isa 38:19; Ps 44:1-2
- v8 — Num 14:18; Ps 103:8; Ps 86:5; Ps 100:5; Ps 116:5
- v9 — Nah 1:7; Ps 100:5; Matt 5:45; Jonah 4:11; Ps 104:27
- v14 — Ps 146:8; Ps 37:24; Ps 94:18; Luke 22:31-32; Ps 119:117
- v15 — Ps 136:25; Ps 104:27; Acts 17:25; Matt 6:26; Ps 147:8-9
- v16 — Ps 104:28; Ps 107:9; Ps 132:15; Job 38:27
- v17 — Deut 32:4; Zeph 3:5; Ps 103:6; Isa 45:21; Ps 116:5
- v18 — Jer 29:12-13; Ps 34:18; Deut 4:7; John 4:24; Isa 58:9
- v19 — Ps 37:4; Eph 3:16-20; John 15:7; Matt 5:6; 1 John 5:15
- v20 — Ex 20:6; John 10:27-29; Rom 8:28-30; Ps 97:10; Ps 31:23

Psalm 146

The psalmist resolves to praise the LORD all his life, warning against trusting in princes whose plans perish when they die. The LORD keeps faith forever, executes justice for the oppressed, gives food to the hungry, sets prisoners free, opens the eyes of the blind, and reigns forever.

1	<i>Praise ye the LORD. Praise the LORD, O my soul.</i>	Praise the LORD. Praise the LORD, my soul.
2	<i>While I live will I praise the LORD: I will sing praises unto my God while I have any being.</i>	I will praise the LORD all my life; I will sing praise to my God as long as I live.
3	<i>Put not your trust in princes, nor in the son of man, in whom there is no help.</i>	Put not Your trust in princes, nor in the son of man, in whom there is no help.
4	<i>His breath goeth forth, he returneth to his earth; in that very day his thoughts perish.</i>	When their spirit departs, they return to the ground; on that very day their plans come to nothing.

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| <p>5 <i>Happy is he that hath the God of Jacob for his help, whose hope is in the LORD his God:</i></p> <p>6 <i>Which made heaven, and earth, the sea, and all that therein is: which keepeth truth for ever:</i></p> <p>7 <i>Which executeth judgment for the oppressed: which giveth food to the hungry. The LORD looseth the prisoners:</i></p> <p>8 <i>The LORD openeth the eyes of the blind: the LORD raiseth them that are bowed down: the LORD loveth the righteous:</i></p> <p>9 <i>The LORD preserveth the strangers; he relieveth the fatherless and widow: but the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.</i></p> <p>10 <i>The LORD shall reign for ever, even thy God, O Zion, unto all generations. Praise ye the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Blessed are those whose help is the God of Jacob, whose hope is in the LORD their God.</p> <p>He is the Maker of heaven and earth, the sea, and everything in them — he remains faithful forever.</p> <p>He upholds the cause of the oppressed and gives food to the hungry. The LORD sets prisoners free,</p> <p>the LORD gives sight to the blind, the LORD lifts up those who are bowed down, the LORD loves the righteous.</p> <p>The LORD watches over the foreigner and sustains the fatherless and the widow, but He frustrates the ways of the wicked.</p> <p>The LORD reigns forever, Your God, O Zion, for all generations. Praise the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 103:22-104:1; Ps 103:1
- v2 — Ps 63:4; Ps 104:33; Ps 71:14-15; Ps 145:1-2; Rev 7:9-17
- v3 — Ps 118:8-9; Jer 17:5-6; Isa 2:22; Ps 108:12; Isa 31:3
- v4 — Eccl 12:7; Ps 104:29; Gen 2:7; Gen 3:19; 1 Cor 2:6
- v5 — Jer 17:7-8; Ps 144:15; Ps 71:5; Ps 33:12; Ps 46:11
- v6 — Rev 14:7; Ex 20:11; Ps 100:5; Ps 136:5-6; Gen 1:1
- v7 — Ps 103:6; Ps 68:6; Isa 61:1; Zech 9:11-12; Prov 22:22-23
- v8 — Ps 145:14; Ps 11:7; Acts 26:18; Matt 9:30; Isa 35:5
- v9 — Ps 68:5; Ps 147:6; Deut 10:18-19; Prov 15:25; Ex 22:21-22
- v10 — Ps 10:16; Ex 15:18; Rev 11:15; Dan 6:26; Dan 7:14

Psalm 147

The psalmist praises the LORD who rebuilds Jerusalem, gathers the outcasts of Israel, and heals the brokenhearted, while also numbering the stars and calling them each by name. He sends snow, frost, and ice, then melts them with His wind, and He has revealed His word and statutes to Israel as to no other nation.

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| 1 <i>Praise ye the LORD: for it is good to sing praises unto our God; for it is pleasant; and praise is comely.</i> | Praise the LORD. How good it is to sing praises to our God, how pleasant and fitting to praise Him! |
| 2 <i>The LORD doth build up Jerusalem: he gathereth together the outcasts of Israel.</i> | The LORD builds up Jerusalem; He gathers the exiles of Israel. |
| 3 <i>He healeth the broken in heart, and bindeth up their wounds.</i> | He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds. |
| 4 <i>He telleth the number of the stars; he calleth them all by their names.</i> | He determines the number of the stars and calls them each by name. |
| 5 <i>Great is our Lord, and of great power: his understanding is infinite.</i> | Great is our Lord and mighty in power; His understanding has no limit. |
| 6 <i>The LORD lifteth up the meek: he casteth the wicked down to the ground.</i> | The LORD sustains the humble but casts the wicked to the ground. |
| 7 <i>Sing unto the LORD with thanksgiving; sing praise upon the harp unto our God:</i> | Sing to the LORD with grateful praise; make music to our God on the harp. |
| 8 <i>Who covereth the heaven with clouds, who prepareth rain for the earth, who maketh grass to grow upon the mountains.</i> | He covers the sky with clouds; He supplies the earth with rain and makes grass grow on the hills. |
| 9 <i>He giveth to the beast his food, and to the young ravens which cry.</i> | He provides food for the cattle and for the young ravens when they call. |
| 10 <i>He delighteth not in the strength of the horse: he taketh not pleasure in the legs of a man.</i> | His pleasure is not in the strength of the horse, nor His delight in the legs of the warrior; |
| 11 <i>The LORD taketh pleasure in them that fear him, in those that hope in his mercy.</i> | the LORD delights in those who fear Him, who put their hope in His mercy. |

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| 12 <i>Praise the LORD, O Jerusalem; praise thy God, O Zion.</i> | Extol the LORD, Jerusalem; praise Your God, Zion. |
| 13 <i>For he hath strengthened the bars of thy gates; he hath blessed thy children within thee.</i> | He strengthens the bars of Your gates and blesses Your people within You. |
| 14 <i>He maketh peace in thy borders, and filleth thee with the finest of the wheat.</i> | He grants peace to Your borders and satisfies You with the finest of wheat. |
| 15 <i>He sendeth forth his commandment upon earth: his word runneth very swiftly.</i> | He sends His command to the earth; His word runs swiftly. |
| 16 <i>He giveth snow like wool: he scattereth the hoarfrost like ashes.</i> | He spreads the snow like wool and scatters the frost like ashes. |
| 17 <i>He casteth forth his ice like morsels: who can stand before his cold?</i> | He hurls down His hail like pebbles. Who can withstand His icy blast? |
| 18 <i>He sendeth out his word, and melteth them: he causeth his wind to blow, and the waters flow.</i> | He sends His word and melts them; He stirs up His breezes, and the waters flow. |
| 19 <i>He sheweth his word unto Jacob, his statutes and his judgments unto Israel.</i> | He has revealed his word to Jacob, his laws and decrees to Israel. |
| 20 <i>He hath not dealt so with any nation: and as for his judgments, they have not known them. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | He has done this for no other nation; they do not know His laws. Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2** — Deut 30:3; Isa 56:8; Ps 51:18; Isa 62:7; Ps 102:20-22
v3 — Ps 34:18; Job 5:18; Jer 33:6; Luke 4:18; Isa 61:1
v4 — Isa 40:26; Ps 8:3; Ps 148:3; Gen 15:5
v5 — Isa 40:28; Ps 139:17-18; Ps 96:4; Rom 11:33; Ps 48:1
v6 — Ps 25:9; Ps 146:8-9; 1 Pet 5:6; Jas 4:10; Ps 149:4
v9 — Ps 104:27-28; Job 38:41; Matt 6:26; Ps 136:25; Ps 145:15-16
v10 — 1 Sam 16:7; Ps 20:7; Isa 31:1; Ps 33:16-18; Prov 21:31
v11 — Ps 33:18; Mal 3:16-17; Zeph 3:17; Ps 149:4; Ps 35:27
v13 — Ps 128:3-6; Ps 115:14-15; Isa 44:3-5; Jer 30:19-20; Ps 144:12

v14 — Ps 29:11; Isa 60:17-18; Ps 81:16; Ps 132:15; Deut 32:14

v15 — Job 37:12; 2 Thess 3:1; Ps 107:20; Ps 33:9; Matt 8:13

v19 — Mal 4:4; Ps 78:5; Deut 33:2-4; Rom 9:4; Deut 5:22

Psalm 148

The psalmist calls all creation to praise the LORD — angels, sun, moon, stars, and the heavens above, then fire, hail, snow, wind, mountains, trees, beasts, birds, kings, and all peoples below. He has exalted the horn of His people, and His name alone is excellent.

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| 1 <i>Praise ye the LORD. Praise ye the LORD from the heavens: praise him in the heights.</i> | Praise the LORD. Praise the LORD from the heavens; praise Him in the heights above. |
| 2 <i>Praise ye him, all his angels: praise ye him, all his hosts.</i> | Praise Him, all His angels; praise Him, all His heavenly hosts. |
| 3 <i>Praise ye him, sun and moon: praise him, all ye stars of light.</i> | Praise Him, sun and moon; praise Him, all You shining stars. |
| 4 <i>Praise him, ye heavens of heavens, and ye waters that be above the heavens.</i> | Praise Him, You highest heavens and You waters above the skies. |
| 5 <i>Let them praise the name of the LORD: for he commanded, and they were created.</i> | Let them praise the name of the LORD, for at His command they were created, |
| 6 <i>He hath also stablished them for ever and ever: he hath made a decree which shall not pass.</i> | and He established them for ever and ever — he issued a decree that will never pass away. |
| 7 <i>Praise the LORD from the earth, ye dragons, and all deeps:</i> | Praise the LORD from the earth, You great sea creatures and all ocean depths, |
| 8 <i>Fire, and hail; snow, and vapour; stormy wind fulfilling his word:</i> | lightning and hail, snow and clouds, stormy winds that do His bidding, |
| 9 <i>Mountains, and all hills; fruitful trees, and all cedars:</i> | you mountains and all hills, fruit trees and all cedars, |
| 10 <i>Beasts, and all cattle; creeping things, and flying fowl:</i> | wild animals and all cattle, small creatures and flying birds, |

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| 11 | <i>Kings of the earth, and all people; princes, and all judges of the earth:</i> | kings of the earth and all nations, You princes and all rulers on earth, |
| 12 | <i>Both young men, and maidens; old men, and children:</i> | young men and women, old men and children. |
| 13 | <i>Let them praise the name of the LORD: for his name alone is excellent; his glory is above the earth and heaven.</i> | Let them praise the name of the LORD, for His name alone is exalted; His splendor is above the earth and the heavens. |
| 14 | <i>He also exalteth the horn of his people, the praise of all his saints; even of the children of Israel, a people near unto him. Praise ye the LORD.</i> | And He has raised up for His people a horn, the praise of all His faithful servants, of Israel, the people close to his heart. Praise the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 69:34; Ps 89:5; Rev 19:1-6; Luke 2:13-14; Matt 21:9
v2 — Ps 103:20-21
v3 — Ps 19:1-6
v4 — 1 Kgs 8:27; Gen 1:7; Deut 10:14
v5 — Rev 4:11; Gen 1:6; Ps 33:6-9; Gen 1:1-2; Jer 10:11-13
v6 — Jer 33:25; Jer 31:35-36; Ps 89:37; Job 38:33; Ps 119:90-91
v7 — Ps 74:13-14; Gen 1:21; Isa 43:20; Ps 104:25-26; Job 41:1-34
v8 — Ps 147:15-18
v9 — Isa 44:23; Isa 49:13
v13 — Ps 113:4; Ps 8:1; Ps 8:9; Isa 12:4
v14 — Ps 75:10; Eph 2:17; Deut 4:7; 1 Sam 2:1; Ps 112:9

Psalm 149

The psalmist calls the saints to sing a new song to the LORD and rejoice in their Maker and King with dancing, timbrel, and harp. He gives them a two-edged sword to execute vengeance on the nations and bind their kings — this honor belongs to all His saints.

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| 1 | <i>Praise ye the LORD. Sing unto the LORD a new song, and his praise in the congregation of saints.</i> | Praise the LORD. Sing to the LORD a new song, His praise in the congregation of saints. |
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2	<i>Let Israel rejoice in him that made him: let the children of Zion be joyful in their King.</i>	Let Israel rejoice in their Maker; let the people of Zion be glad in their King.
3	<i>Let them praise his name in the dance: let them sing praises unto him with the timbrel and harp.</i>	Let them praise His name with dancing and make music to Him with timbrel and harp.
4	<i>For the LORD taketh pleasure in his people: he will beautify the meek with salvation.</i>	For the LORD takes delight in His people; He crowns the humble with victory.
5	<i>Let the saints be joyful in glory: let them sing aloud upon their beds.</i>	Let the saints be joyful in glory; let them sing aloud on their beds.
6	<i>Let the high praises of God be in their mouth, and a twoedged sword in their hand;</i>	May the praise of God be in their mouths and a double-edged sword in their hands,
7	<i>To execute vengeance upon the heathen, and punishments upon the people;</i>	to inflict vengeance on the nations and punishment on the peoples,
8	<i>To bind their kings with chains, and their nobles with fetters of iron;</i>	to bind their kings with fetters, their nobles with shackles of iron,
9	<i>To execute upon them the judgment written: this honour have all his saints. Praise ye the LORD.</i>	to execute on them the judgment written; this honor have all His saints. Praise the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 33:3; Rev 5:9; Ps 148:1; Heb 2:12; Ps 98:1
- v2 — Ps 100:1-3; Ps 95:6; Isa 54:5; Isa 52:7; Deut 7:6-7
- v3 — Jer 31:13; Ps 81:2; 2 Sam 6:16; 2 Sam 6:14; 1 Chr 15:28-29
- v4 — Ps 147:11; 1 Pet 3:4; Ps 35:27; Ps 132:16; Zeph 3:17
- v5 — Job 35:10; Ps 42:8; 1 Pet 1:8
- v6 — Heb 4:12; Ps 66:17; Rev 1:16; Rev 19:6; Neh 9:5
- v9 — 1 Cor 6:2-3; Ps 148:14

Psalm 150

The final psalm calls everything and everyone to praise the LORD in His sanctuary with every instrument — trumpet, harp, lyre, timbrel, strings, pipe, and cymbals. It closes the entire Psalter with the command: let everything that has breath praise the LORD.

1	<i>Praise ye the LORD. Praise God in his sanctuary: praise him in the firmament of his power.</i>	Praise the LORD. Praise God in His sanctuary; praise Him in His mighty firmament.
2	<i>Praise him for his mighty acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness.</i>	Praise Him for His acts of power; praise Him for His surpassing greatness.
3	<i>Praise him with the sound of the trumpet: praise him with the psaltery and harp.</i>	Praise Him with the sounding of the trumpet, praise Him with the harp and lyre,
4	<i>Praise him with the timbrel and dance: praise him with stringed instruments and organs.</i>	praise Him with timbrel and dancing, praise Him with the strings and pipe,
5	<i>Praise him upon the loud cymbals: praise him upon the high sounding cymbals.</i>	praise Him with the clash of cymbals, praise Him with resounding cymbals.
6	<i>Let every thing that hath breath praise the LORD. Praise ye the LORD.</i>	Let everything that has breath praise the LORD. Praise the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 149:1; Ps 134:2; Ps 116:18-19; Ps 29:9
- v2 — Deut 3:24; Jer 32:17-19; Ps 145:3; Rev 15:3-4; Ps 145:5-6
- v3 — Ps 33:2; Ps 149:3; Ps 98:5-6; Ps 81:2-3
- v4 — Isa 38:20; Ps 149:3; Ex 15:20; Ps 144:9
- v5 — 1 Chr 15:16; 1 Chr 25:1; 1 Chr 15:19; 1 Chr 15:28
- v6 — Ps 145:21; Rev 5:13; Ps 103:22; Ps 145:10; Ps 148:7-11

Proverbs

Author: *Primarily Solomon the son of David, king of Israel — named at 1:1, 10:1, and 25:1 ("proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out"). Chapter 30 is attributed to Agur the son of Jakeh, and chapter 31 to King Lemuel, recording the prophecy his mother taught him.*

Date written: *c. 970–700 BC. Solomon composed the original collections during his reign (c. 970–930 BC). The "men of Hezekiah" copied out additional proverbs of Solomon around 700 BC (25:1). The dates of Agur and Lemuel are unknown.*

Written to: *Young men of Israel — and by extension, all who seek wisdom. The repeated address "my son" runs throughout the first nine chapters, establishing the tone of a father instructing his children in the way of the LORD.*

Setting: *The royal court and the home. A father sits with his son and passes down the hard-won wisdom of generations — what to pursue, what to avoid, how to speak, how to work, how to fear God. The setting is everyday life: the marketplace, the field, the gate of the city, the marriage bed, the table of a ruler.*

Where this sits historically: *Composed mostly during Solomon's reign (c. 970–930 BC) at the height of the united kingdom's wealth and influence, with a later editorial expansion under King Hezekiah of Judah around 700 BC.*

Contemporaries: *Solomon ruled while the Phoenician king Hiram, the queen of Sheba, and Pharaoh of Egypt looked on; the Hezekiah-era additions were made while Isaiah and Micah prophesied and Assyria threatened Jerusalem.*

Big themes:

- *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge and wisdom (1:7, 9:10) — this is the foundation on which everything else in the book rests*
- *Wisdom personified as a woman calling aloud in the streets, inviting the simple to turn in and live (1:20–33, 8:1–36, 9:1–6)*
- *The sharp contrast between the wise and the foolish, the righteous and the wicked — nearly every verse in chapters 10–29 sets one against the other*
- *Warnings against adultery and the "strange woman" whose house is the way to hell (2:16–19, 5:1–23, 6:20–35, 7:1–27)*
- *Diligence versus laziness — the ant and the sluggard (6:6–11, 24:30–34)*
- *The power of the tongue — life and death are in it (10:19–21, 12:18, 15:1–4, 18:21)*
- *The virtuous woman of chapter 31 — the portrait of a woman who fears the LORD and whose works praise her in the gates*

Key passages: *1:7; 3:5–6; 9:10; 22:6; 31:10–31*

How it fits: *Proverbs is the practical application of the fear of God — what wisdom looks like lived out day by day. If the Psalms teach Israel how to worship, Proverbs teaches Israel how to*

live. It stands between Job (which asks why the righteous suffer) and Ecclesiastes (which asks what life means under the sun), giving the everyday answer: fear the LORD, walk uprightly, guard your tongue, do your work, love your wife, raise your children, and trust that God sees all.

Chapter 1

The father introduces the purpose of Proverbs — to give wisdom, instruction, and knowledge — and lays the foundation: the fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge. He warns his son against the enticement of sinners, and Wisdom herself cries in the streets, promising security to those who listen and ruin to those who refuse.

- 1

The proverbs of Solomon the son of David, king of Israel;

The proverbs of Solomon the son of David, king of Israel:
- **NAME NOTE** — **Solomon** (SOL-oh-mun) — "peace" — Son of David and Bathsheba, third king of Israel, and the wisest man who ever lived (1 Kings 3:12). God gave him wisdom that surpassed all the men of the east and all the wisdom of Egypt. He spoke three thousand proverbs (1 Kings 4:32). The bulk of this book is his.
- 2

To know wisdom and instruction; to perceive the words of understanding;

to know wisdom and instruction, to discern words of understanding;
- 3

To receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, and judgment, and equity;

to receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, judgment, and fairness;
- 4

To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion.

to give shrewdness to the simple, and to the young man knowledge and discretion.
- 5

A wise man will hear, and will increase learning; and a man of understanding shall attain unto wise counsels:

A wise man will hear and increase in learning, and a man of understanding will gain wise counsel:
- 6

To understand a proverb, and the interpretation; the words of the wise, and their dark sayings.

to understand a proverb and its interpretation, the words of the wise and their riddles.
- 7

The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.

The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge; but fools despise wisdom and instruction.

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| 8 | <i>My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:</i> | My son, hear the instruction of Your father, and do not forsake the teaching of Your mother. |
| 9 | <i>For they shall be an ornament of grace unto thy head, and chains about thy neck.</i> | For they will be an ornament of grace on Your head, and chains around Your neck. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

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| 10 | <i>My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not.</i> | My son, if sinners entice You, do not consent. |
| 11 | <i>If they say, Come with us, let us lay wait for blood, let us lurk privily for the innocent without cause:</i> | If they say, "Come with us; let us lie in wait for blood, let us secretly ambush the innocent without cause; |
| 12 | <i>Let us swallow them up alive as the grave; and whole, as those that go down into the pit:</i> | let us swallow them up alive like the grave, and whole, like those who go down into the pit; |
| 13 | <i>We shall find all precious substance, we shall fill our houses with spoil:</i> | we will find all kinds of precious goods, we will fill our houses with plunder; |
| 14 | <i>Cast in thy lot among us; let us all have one purse:</i> | cast in your lot with us; we will all share one purse" — |
| 15 | <i>My son, walk not thou in the way with them; refrain thy foot from their path:</i> | my son, do not walk in the way with them; keep your foot from their path. |
| 16 | <i>For their feet run to evil, and make haste to shed blood.</i> | For their feet run to evil, and they hurry to shed blood. |
| 17 | <i>Surely in vain the net is spread in the sight of any bird.</i> | Surely in vain the net is spread in the sight of any bird. |
| 18 | <i>And they lay wait for their own blood; they lurk privily for their own lives.</i> | They lie in wait for their own blood; they secretly ambush their own lives. |
| 19 | <i>So are the ways of every one that is greedy of gain; which taketh away the life of the owners thereof.</i> | Such are the ways of everyone who is greedy for gain; it takes away the life of those who possess it. |

- 20 *Wisdom crieth without; she uttereth her voice in the streets:* Wisdom cries aloud outside; she raises her voice in the streets.
- 21 *She crieth in the chief place of concourse, in the openings of the gates: in the city she uttereth her words, saying,* She cries out in the chief places of gathering, at the openings of the gates; in the city she speaks her words:
- 22 *How long, ye simple ones, will ye love simplicity? and the scorers delight in their scorning, and fools hate knowledge?* "How long, you simple ones, will you love simplicity? How long will scorers delight in their scorning, and fools hate knowledge?
- 23 *Turn you at my reproof: behold, I will pour out my spirit unto you, I will make known my words unto you.* Turn at my rebuke. I will pour out my spirit to you; I will make known my words to you.
- 24 *Because I have called, and ye refused; I have stretched out my hand, and no man regarded;* Because I have called and you refused, I have stretched out my hand and no one paid heed;
- 25 *But ye have set at nought all my counsel, and would none of my reproof:* because you set at nothing all my counsel, and would have none of my rebuke,
- 26 *I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock when your fear cometh;* I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock when your fear comes —
- 27 *When your fear cometh as desolation, and your destruction cometh as a whirlwind; when distress and anguish cometh upon you.* when your fear comes like desolation, and your destruction comes like a whirlwind, when distress and anguish come on you.
- 28 *Then shall they call upon me, but I will not answer; they shall seek me early, but they shall not find me:* Then they will call on me, but I will not answer; they will seek me early, but they will not find me.
- 29 *For that they hated knowledge, and did not choose the fear of the LORD:* Because they hated knowledge and did not choose the fear of the LORD,
- 30 *They would none of my counsel: they despised all my reproof.* they would have none of my counsel; they despised all my rebuke.

31	<i>Therefore shall they eat of the fruit of their own way, and be filled with their own devices.</i>	Therefore they will eat the fruit of their own way, and be filled with their own devices.
32	<i>For the turning away of the simple shall slay them, and the prosperity of fools shall destroy them.</i>	For the turning away of the simple will slay them, and the prosperity of fools will destroy them.
33	<i>But whoso hearkeneth unto me shall dwell safely, and shall be quiet from fear of evil.</i>	But whoever listens to me will live safely, and will be at peace, without fear of evil."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 10:1; 1 Chr 22:9; 1 Chr 28:5
- v5 — Prov 12:1; Prov 9:9; 1 Cor 10:15; Job 34:10; Job 34:16
- v6 — Ps 78:2; Mark 4:11; Ps 49:4; Acts 8:30-31; Mark 4:34
- v7 — Job 28:28; Ps 111:10-112:1; Eccl 12:13; Prov 9:10; Prov 15:33
- v10 — Eph 5:11; Ps 1:1; Prov 16:29; Prov 13:20; Rom 16:18
- v15 — Ps 119:101; Ps 1:1; Prov 4:14-15; Prov 4:27; Ps 26:4-5
- v23 — Acts 3:19; Ezek 33:11; Ezek 18:27-30; Acts 2:36-38; Joel 2:28
- v24 — Rom 10:21; Isa 65:12; Jer 7:13; Isa 66:4; Heb 12:25-26
- v26 — Ps 37:13; Ps 2:4; Prov 10:24; Luke 14:24; Prov 6:15
- v28 — Mic 3:4; Isa 1:15; Jer 11:11; Jas 4:3; Zech 7:13
- v31 — Prov 14:14; Jer 6:19; Prov 22:8; Job 4:8; Gal 6:7-8
- v33 — Ps 25:12-13; Ps 112:7-8; Isa 26:3; John 10:27-29; Prov 14:26

Chapter 2

The father instructs his son to seek wisdom as eagerly as silver and hidden treasure, promising that the LORD gives wisdom and guards the paths of the just. Wisdom delivers from the way of the evil man and from the strange woman whose house leads to death.

1	<i>My son, if thou wilt receive my words, and hide my commandments with thee;</i>	My son, if You will receive my words and treasure up my commandments with You,
2	<i>So that thou incline thine ear unto wisdom, and apply thine heart to understanding;</i>	so that You incline Your ear to wisdom and apply Your heart to understanding;

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| 3 | <i>Yea, if thou criest after knowledge,
and liftest up thy voice for
understanding;</i> | if You cry out for knowledge and lift
up Your voice for understanding; |
| 4 | <i>If thou seekest her as silver, and
searchest for her as for hid treasures;</i> | if You seek her as silver, and search
for her as for hidden treasures, |
| 5 | <i>Then shalt thou understand the fear of
the LORD, and find the knowledge of
God.</i> | then You will understand the fear of
the LORD, and find the knowledge of
God. |
| 6 | <i>For the LORD giveth wisdom: out of
his mouth cometh knowledge and
understanding.</i> | For the LORD gives wisdom; out of
His mouth come knowledge and
understanding. |
| 7 | <i>He layeth up sound wisdom for the
righteous: he is a buckler to them that
walk uprightly.</i> | He stores up sound wisdom for the
righteous; he is a shield to those who
walk uprightly. |
| 8 | <i>He keepeth the paths of judgment, and
preserveth the way of his saints.</i> | He guards the paths of justice, and
preserves the way of His saints. |
| 9 | <i>Then shalt thou understand
righteousness, and judgment, and
equity; yea, every good path.</i> | Then You will understand
righteousness, justice, and fairness —
every good path. |
| 10 | <i>When wisdom entereth into thine
heart, and knowledge is pleasant unto
thy soul;</i> | When wisdom enters Your heart, and
knowledge is pleasant to Your soul, |
| 11 | <i>Discretion shall preserve thee,
understanding shall keep thee:</i> | discretion will preserve You, and
understanding will keep You, |
| 12 | <i>To deliver thee from the way of the
evil man, from the man that speaketh
froward things;</i> | to deliver you from the way of the evil
man, from the man who speaks
perverse things, |
| 13 | <i>Who leave the paths of uprightness, to
walk in the ways of darkness;</i> | who leave the paths of uprightness to
walk in the ways of darkness, |
| 14 | <i>Who rejoyce to do evil, and delight in
the frowardness of the wicked;</i> | who rejoyce to do evil and delight in
the perverseness of the wicked, |
| 15 | <i>Whose ways are crooked, and they
froward in their paths:</i> | whose ways are crooked, and who are
perverse in their paths. |

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| 16 <i>To deliver thee from the strange woman, even from the stranger which flattereth with her words;</i> | Wisdom will deliver you from the strange woman, even from the stranger who flatters with her words, |
| 17 <i>Which forsaketh the guide of her youth, and forgetteth the covenant of her God.</i> | who forsakes the guide of her youth and forgets the covenant of her God. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-eh-nunt) — A binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. Here it refers to the marriage covenant made before God.

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| 18 <i>For her house inclineth unto death, and her paths unto the dead.</i> | For her house leans toward death, and her paths to the dead. |
| 19 <i>None that go unto her return again, neither take they hold of the paths of life.</i> | None who go to her return again, nor do they take hold of the paths of life. |
| 20 <i>That thou mayest walk in the way of good men, and keep the paths of the righteous.</i> | So you may walk in the way of good men, and keep the paths of the righteous. |
| 21 <i>For the upright shall dwell in the land, and the perfect shall remain in it.</i> | For the upright will live in the land, and the blameless will remain in it. |
| 22 <i>But the wicked shall be cut off from the earth, and the transgressors shall be rooted out of it.</i> | But the wicked will be cut off from the earth, and the transgressors will be rooted out of it. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 3:1; Prov 1:3; Prov 4:1; Deut 6:6-9; John 12:47-48
- v2 — Prov 23:12; Prov 18:1; Ps 119:111-112; Ps 90:12; Matt 13:9
- v3 — Jas 1:5; Eph 1:17-18; Prov 3:6
- v4 — Matt 13:44; Matt 19:29; Prov 16:16; Job 28:12-20; Prov 8:18-19
- v5 — Prov 1:7; Jer 24:7; 2 Chr 1:10-12; Jer 32:40-41; Luke 10:22
- v6 — Eph 1:17-18; Jas 1:5; Luke 21:15; Job 32:8; Isa 54:13
- v7 — Jas 3:15-17; Prov 30:5; Ps 84:11; 1 Cor 3:18-19; 1 Cor 1:19
- v8 — Ps 23:3; 1 Sam 2:9; John 10:28-29; Ps 145:20; Ps 66:9
- v11 — Prov 4:6; Eph 5:15; Ps 25:21

v16 — Eccl 7:26; Prov 22:14; Prov 7:5-23; Prov 6:24; Prov 23:27
v21 — Ps 84:11; Ps 37:29; Ps 37:9; Prov 10:30
v22 — Ps 52:5; Deut 7:22; Isa 3:10-11; Ps 37:28; Ps 145:20

Chapter 3

The father urges his son to trust in the LORD with all his heart and lean not on his own understanding, promising that God directs the paths of those who acknowledge Him in all their ways. He exalts wisdom as more precious than rubies and as the very means by which God founded the earth.

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| 1 | <i>My son, forget not my law; but let thine heart keep my commandments:</i> | My son, do not forget my law, but let Your heart keep my commandments. |
| 2 | <i>For length of days, and long life, and peace, shall they add to thee.</i> | For they will add length of days, long life, and peace to You. |
| 3 | <i>Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart:</i> | Do not let mercy and truth forsake You; bind them around Your neck; write them on the tablet of Your heart. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. In the KJV, "mercy" often translates Hebrew *chesed* — the loyal, covenant love of God toward His people.

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| 4 | <i>So shalt thou find favour and good understanding in the sight of God and man.</i> | So You will find favor and good understanding in the sight of God and man. |
| 5 | <i>Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding.</i> | Trust in the LORD with all Your heart, and lean not on Your own understanding. |
| 6 | <i>In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.</i> | In all Your ways acknowledge Him, and He shall direct Your paths. |
| 7 | <i>Be not wise in thine own eyes: fear the LORD, and depart from evil.</i> | Do not be wise in Your own eyes; fear the LORD and depart from evil. |
| 8 | <i>It shall be health to thy navel, and marrow to thy bones.</i> | It will be health to Your body and marrow to Your bones. |
| 9 | <i>Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase:</i> | Honor the LORD with Your substance, and with the firstfruits of all Your increase. |

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| 10 <i>So shall thy barns be filled with plenty, and thy presses shall burst out with new wine.</i> | So Your barns will be filled with plenty, and Your presses will burst out with new wine. |
| 11 <i>My son, despise not the chastening of the LORD; neither be weary of his correction:</i> | My son, do not despise the chastening of the LORD, nor be weary of His correction. |
| 12 <i>For whom the LORD loveth he correcteth; even as a father the son in whom he delighteth.</i> | For whom the LORD loves He corrects, even as a father the son in whom He delights. |
| 13 <i>Happy is the man that findeth wisdom, and the man that getteth understanding.</i> | Happy is the man who finds wisdom, and the man who gains understanding. |
| 14 <i>For the merchandise of it is better than the merchandise of silver, and the gain thereof than fine gold.</i> | For her gain is better than the gain of silver, and her profit better than fine gold. |
| 15 <i>She is more precious than rubies: and all the things thou canst desire are not to be compared unto her.</i> | She is more precious than rubies, and all the things you can desire cannot be compared to her. |
| 16 <i>Length of days is in her right hand; and in her left hand riches and honour.</i> | Length of days is in her right hand, and in her left hand are riches and honor. |
| 17 <i>Her ways are ways of pleasantness, and all her paths are peace.</i> | Her ways are ways of pleasantness, and all her paths are peace. |
| 18 <i>She is a tree of life to them that lay hold upon her: and happy is every one that retaineth her.</i> | She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her, and happy is everyone who keeps her. |
| 19 <i>The LORD by wisdom hath founded the earth; by understanding hath he established the heavens.</i> | By wisdom the LORD has founded the earth; by understanding He has established the heavens. |
| 20 <i>By his knowledge the depths are broken up, and the clouds drop down the dew.</i> | By His knowledge the depths are broken open, and the clouds drop down the dew. |

- 21 *My son, let not them depart from thine eyes: keep sound wisdom and discretion:* My son, do not let them depart from Your eyes; keep sound wisdom and discretion.
- 22 *So shall they be life unto thy soul, and grace to thy neck.* So they will be life to Your soul and grace to Your neck.
- 23 *Then shalt thou walk in thy way safely, and thy foot shall not stumble.* Then You will walk on Your way safely, and Your foot will not stumble.
- 24 *When thou liest down, thou shalt not be afraid: yea, thou shalt lie down, and thy sleep shall be sweet.* When You lie down, You will not be afraid; You will lie down, and Your sleep will be sweet.
- 25 *Be not afraid of sudden fear, neither of the desolation of the wicked, when it cometh.* Do not be afraid of sudden fear, nor of the desolation of the wicked when it comes.
- 26 *For the LORD shall be thy confidence, and shall keep thy foot from being taken.* For the LORD will be Your confidence, and will keep Your foot from being caught.
- 27 *Withhold not good from them to whom it is due, when it is in the power of thine hand to do it.* Do not withhold good from those to whom it is due, when it is in the power of Your hand to do it.
- 28 *Say not unto thy neighbour, Go, and come again, and to morrow I will give; when thou hast it by thee.* Do not say to Your neighbor, "Go, and come again, and tomorrow I will give," when You have it with You.
- 29 *Devise not evil against thy neighbour, seeing he dwelleth securely by thee.* Do not devise evil against Your neighbor, since He lives securely beside You.
- 30 *Strive not with a man without cause, if he have done thee no harm.* Do not contend with a man without cause, if he has done you no harm.
- 31 *Envy thou not the oppressor, and choose none of his ways.* Do not envy the oppressor, and choose none of His ways.
- 32 *For the froward is abomination to the LORD: but his secret is with the righteous.* For the perverse are an abomination to the LORD; but His secret is with the righteous.

33	<i>The curse of the LORD is in the house of the wicked: but he blesseth the habitation of the just.</i>	The curse of the LORD is on the house of the wicked; but he blesses the habitation of the just.
34	<i>Surely he scorneth the scorers: but he giveth grace to the lowly.</i>	Surely He scorns the scorers; but He gives grace to the lowly.
35	<i>The wise shall inherit glory: but shame shall be the promotion of fools.</i>	The wise will inherit glory; but shame will be the promotion of fools.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 14:21-24; Prov 4:5; Deut 6:6-9; Ps 119:16; Prov 1:8
- v2 — Eph 6:1-3; Prov 4:10; Ps 91:16; Prov 9:11; Ps 128:6
- v3 — Prov 7:3; 2 Cor 3:3; Heb 10:16; Deut 11:18-21; Mal 2:6
- v4 — Luke 2:52; 1 Sam 2:26; Rom 14:18; Ps 111:10; Gen 39:2-4
- v5 — Ps 37:5; Jer 17:7-8; Prov 28:26; Ps 37:3; Ps 62:8
- v6 — Prov 16:3; Ps 32:8; Phil 4:6; Prov 16:9; Jer 10:23
- v7 — Job 28:28; Rom 12:16; Prov 26:12; Prov 16:6; Job 1:1
- v9 — Deut 26:2-15; 1 Cor 16:2; Ex 23:19; Prov 14:31; Phil 4:17-18
- v11 — Job 5:17; Rev 3:19; Heb 12:5-12; Ps 94:12; Isa 40:30-31
- v12 — Deut 8:5; Rev 3:19; Prov 29:17; Prov 13:24; Ps 103:13
- v26 — Ps 91:3; 1 Sam 2:9; Prov 14:26; Ps 91:9-10; Hab 3:17-18
- v27 — Gal 6:10; Jas 2:15-16; Rom 13:7; Jas 5:4

Chapter 4

The father passes down the instruction he received from his own father, pleading with his sons to get wisdom above all else and guard their hearts, for out of them flow the issues of life. He commands them to keep their eyes fixed straight ahead and to ponder the path of their feet.

1	<i>Hear, ye children, the instruction of a father, and attend to know understanding.</i>	Listen, my children, to the instruction of a father, and pay attention to know understanding.
2	<i>For I give you good doctrine, forsake ye not my law.</i>	For I give you good doctrine; do not forsake my law.
3	<i>For I was my father's son, tender and only beloved in the sight of my mother.</i>	For I was my father's son, tender and the only beloved in the sight of my mother.

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| 4 | <i>He taught me also, and said unto me,
Let thine heart retain my words: keep
my commandments, and live.</i> | He also taught me, and said to me, "Let
your heart hold fast my words; keep
my commandments, and live. |
| 5 | <i>Get wisdom, get understanding:
forget it not; neither decline from the
words of my mouth.</i> | Get wisdom, get understanding; do not
forget, nor turn aside from the words
of my mouth. |
| 6 | <i>Forsake her not, and she shall
preserve thee: love her, and she shall
keep thee.</i> | Do not forsake her, and she will
preserve you; love her, and she will
keep you. |
| 7 | <i>Wisdom is the principal thing;
therefore get wisdom: and with all thy
getting get understanding.</i> | Wisdom is the principal thing;
therefore get wisdom, and with all your
getting, get understanding. |
| 8 | <i>Exalt her, and she shall promote thee:
she shall bring thee to honour, when
thou dost embrace her.</i> | Exalt her, and she will promote you;
she will bring you to honor when you
embrace her. |
| 9 | <i>She shall give to thine head an
ornament of grace: a crown of glory
shall she deliver to thee.</i> | She will place on your head an
ornament of grace; a crown of glory
she will deliver to you." |
| 10 | <i>Hear, O my son, and receive my
sayings; and the years of thy life shall
be many.</i> | Hear, my son, and receive my sayings,
and the years of your life will be many. |
| 11 | <i>I have taught thee in the way of
wisdom; I have led thee in right paths.</i> | I have taught you in the way of
wisdom; I have led you in right paths. |
| 12 | <i>When thou goest, thy steps shall not
be straitened; and when thou runnest,
thou shalt not stumble.</i> | When you walk, your steps will not be
hindered, and when you run, you will
not stumble. |
| 13 | <i>Take fast hold of instruction; let her
not go: keep her; for she is thy life.</i> | Take firm hold of instruction; do not
let her go. Keep her, for she is your
life. |
| 14 | <i>Enter not into the path of the wicked,
and go not in the way of evil men.</i> | Do not enter the path of the wicked,
and do not go in the way of evil men. |
| 15 | <i>Avoid it, pass not by it, turn from it,
and pass away.</i> | Avoid it; do not travel on it. Turn from
it, and pass on. |

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| 16 <i>For they sleep not, except they have done mischief; and their sleep is taken away, unless they cause some to fall.</i> | For they do not sleep unless they have done mischief, and their sleep is taken away unless they cause someone to fall. |
| 17 <i>For they eat the bread of wickedness, and drink the wine of violence.</i> | For they eat the bread of wickedness and drink the wine of violence. |
| 18 <i>But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day.</i> | But the path of the just is like a shining light that shines more and more to the perfect day. |
| 19 <i>The way of the wicked is as darkness: they know not at what they stumble.</i> | The way of the wicked is like darkness; they do not know what makes them stumble. |
| 20 <i>My son, attend to my words; incline thine ear unto my sayings.</i> | My son, pay attention to my words; incline your ear to my sayings. |
| 21 <i>Let them not depart from thine eyes; keep them in the midst of thine heart.</i> | Do not let them depart from your eyes; keep them in the midst of your heart. |
| 22 <i>For they are life unto those that find them, and health to all their flesh.</i> | For they are life to those who find them, and health to all their flesh. |
| 23 <i>Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.</i> | Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it are the issues of life. |
| 24 <i>Put away from thee a froward mouth, and perverse lips put far from thee.</i> | Put away from you a perverse mouth, and put deceitful lips far from you. |
| 25 <i>Let thine eyes look right on, and let thine eyelids look straight before thee.</i> | Let your eyes look straight ahead, and let your eyelids look right in front of you. |
| 26 <i>Ponder the path of thy feet, and let all thy ways be established.</i> | Ponder the path of your feet, and let all your ways be established. |
| 27 <i>Turn not to the right hand nor to the left: remove thy foot from evil.</i> | Do not turn to the right hand or to the left; remove your foot from evil. |

Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

v4 — Prov 3:1; Eph 6:4; John 12:50; 1 Chr 28:9; Prov 7:2

v7 — Eccl 7:12; Eccl 9:16-18; Prov 23:23; Prov 16:16; Phil 3:8
v13 — Heb 2:1; Prov 23:23; Prov 3:18; 1 Thess 5:21; Deut 32:47
v14 — Ps 1:1; 1 Cor 15:33; Prov 1:10; Prov 1:15; Prov 13:20
v18 — John 8:12; Job 11:17; Dan 12:3; Phil 2:15; 2 Cor 3:18
v20 — Prov 5:1; Isa 55:3; Prov 7:1; Prov 6:20-21; Ps 78:1
v22 — Prov 12:18; Prov 4:10; Jer 33:6; Prov 3:8; Prov 4:4
v23 — Luke 4:45; Matt 12:34-35; Mark 7:21-23; Ps 139:23-24; Prov 13:3
v24 — Prov 8:8; Jas 1:26; Prov 8:13; Prov 6:12; Eph 4:25-31
v25 — Ps 119:37; Matt 6:22; Job 31:1; Prov 23:33
v26 — Ps 37:23; Heb 12:13; Ps 119:5; 2 Thess 3:3; Hag 1:5
v27 — Deut 5:32; Josh 1:7; Deut 28:14; Prov 16:17; Deut 12:32

Chapter 5

The father warns his son against the seductive words of the strange woman, whose lips drip honey but whose end is bitter as wormwood. He urges him to drink water from his own well — to find delight in the wife of his youth — and to remember that the LORD sees every path a man takes.

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| 1 | <i>My son, attend unto my wisdom, and bow thine ear to my understanding:</i> | My son, pay attention to my wisdom; bow Your ear to my understanding, |
| 2 | <i>That thou mayest regard discretion, and that thy lips may keep knowledge.</i> | so that You may keep discretion, and that Your lips may preserve knowledge. |
| 3 | <i>For the lips of a strange woman drop as an honeycomb, and her mouth is smoother than oil:</i> | For the lips of a strange woman drip like a honeycomb, and her mouth is smoother than oil; |
| 4 | <i>But her end is bitter as wormwood, sharp as a twoedged sword.</i> | but in the end she is bitter as wormwood, sharp as a two-edged sword. |
| 5 | <i>Her feet go down to death; her steps take hold on hell.</i> | Her feet go down to death; her steps take hold on hell. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — *The place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant; eternal separation from God. The KJV uses one English word where the Hebrew has Sheol. The modern column preserves "hell" wherever the KJV uses it.*

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| 6 | <i>Lest thou shouldest ponder the path of life, her ways are moveable, that thou canst not know them.</i> | Lest You should ponder the path of life, her ways are unstable; You cannot know them. |
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| 7 <i>Hear me now therefore, O ye children, and depart not from the words of my mouth.</i> | Therefore listen to me now, my children, and do not depart from the words of my mouth. |
| 8 <i>Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house:</i> | Remove Your way far from her, and do not go near the door of her house, |
| 9 <i>Lest thou give thine honour unto others, and thy years unto the cruel:</i> | lest You give Your honor to others and Your years to the cruel; |
| 10 <i>Lest strangers be filled with thy wealth; and thy labours be in the house of a stranger;</i> | lest strangers be filled with Your wealth, and Your labors end up in the house of a stranger; |
| 11 <i>And thou mourn at the last, when thy flesh and thy body are consumed,</i> | and You mourn at the last, when Your flesh and body are consumed, |
| 12 <i>And say, How have I hated instruction, and my heart despised reproof;</i> | and say, "How I have hated instruction, and my heart despised correction! |
| 13 <i>And have not obeyed the voice of my teachers, nor inclined mine ear to them that instructed me!</i> | I have not obeyed the voice of my teachers, nor inclined my ear to those who instructed me. |
| 14 <i>I was almost in all evil in the midst of the congregation and assembly.</i> | I was at the brink of total ruin in the midst of the congregation and assembly." |
| 15 <i>Drink waters out of thine own cistern, and running waters out of thine own well.</i> | Drink water from Your own cistern, and running water from Your own well. |
| 16 <i>Let thy fountains be dispersed abroad, and rivers of waters in the streets.</i> | Should Your fountains be dispersed abroad, and rivers of water in the streets? |
| 17 <i>Let them be only thine own, and not strangers' with thee.</i> | Let them be only Your own, and not for strangers with You. |
| 18 <i>Let thy fountain be blessed: and rejoice with the wife of thy youth.</i> | Let Your fountain be blessed, and rejoice with the wife of Your youth. |

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| <p>19 <i>Let her be as the loving hind and pleasant roe; let her breasts satisfy thee at all times; and be thou ravished always with her love.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And why wilt thou, my son, be ravished with a strange woman, and embrace the bosom of a stranger?</i></p> <p>21 <i>For the ways of man are before the eyes of the LORD, and he pondereth all his goings.</i></p> <p>22 <i>His own iniquities shall take the wicked himself, and he shall be holden with the cords of his sins.</i></p> | <p>Let her be as a loving hind and a graceful doe; let her breasts satisfy You at all times, and always be enraptured with her love.</p> <p>Why will You, my son, be enraptured with a strange woman, and embrace the bosom of a stranger?</p> <p>For the ways of man are before the eyes of the LORD, and He ponders all His paths.</p> <p>His own iniquities will trap the wicked, and he will be held with the cords of his sins.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Iniquity* (in-ik-wih-tee) — Deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. Iniquity is the bent nature that produces sinful behavior.

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| <p>23 <i>He shall die without instruction; and in the greatness of his folly he shall go astray.</i></p> | <p>He will die for lack of instruction, and in the greatness of his folly he will go astray.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 22:17; Prov 4:20; Prov 2:1; Rev 2:11; Rev 2:17
- v2 — Prov 16:23; Mal 2:6-7; Prov 15:7
- v3 — Prov 2:16; Prov 6:24; Prov 7:5; Ps 55:21; Prov 7:21
- v4 — Eccl 7:26; Ps 57:4; Ps 55:21
- v8 — Eph 5:11; Prov 7:25; Prov 4:15; Matt 6:13; Prov 6:27-28
- v12 — Prov 12:1; Prov 1:25; Prov 1:7; Prov 15:5; Prov 1:22
- v15 — 1 Cor 7:2-5; Heb 13:4; Prov 5:18-19
- v16 — Ps 128:3; Ps 127:3
- v18 — Eccl 9:9; Mal 2:14-15
- v19 — Song 7:3; Song 8:14; Song 2:9; Song 4:5
- v21 — Heb 4:13; Prov 15:3; Job 34:21; Jer 32:19; Jer 16:17
- v23 — Job 36:12; Job 4:21; 2 Pet 2:15-22

Chapter 6

The father warns against surety for a stranger, laziness (sending the sluggard to the ant for instruction), and the seven things the LORD hates: a proud look, a lying tongue, hands that shed innocent blood, a scheming heart, feet that run to evil, a false witness, and one who sows discord. He closes with a sustained warning against adultery, which brings wounds and dishonor that cannot be wiped away.

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| 1 | <i>My son, if thou be surety for thy friend, if thou hast stricken thy hand with a stranger,</i> | My son, if You have become surety for Your friend, if You have struck Your hand in pledge for a stranger, |
| 2 | <i>Thou art snared with the words of thy mouth, thou art taken with the words of thy mouth.</i> | you are snared by the words of Your mouth; You are caught by the words of Your mouth. |
| 3 | <i>Do this now, my son, and deliver thyself, when thou art come into the hand of thy friend; go, humble thyself, and make sure thy friend.</i> | Do this now, my son, and deliver Yourself when You have come into the hand of Your friend: go, humble Yourself, and plead urgently with Your friend. |
| 4 | <i>Give not sleep to thine eyes, nor slumber to thine eyelids.</i> | Give no sleep to Your eyes, nor slumber to Your eyelids. |
| 5 | <i>Deliver thyself as a roe from the hand of the hunter, and as a bird from the hand of the fowler.</i> | Deliver Yourself like a roe from the hand of the hunter, and like a bird from the hand of the fowler. |
| 6 | <i>Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:</i> | Go to the ant, You sluggard; consider her ways and be wise. |
| 7 | <i>Which having no guide, overseer, or ruler,</i> | She has no guide, overseer, or ruler, |
| 8 | <i>Provideth her meat in the summer, and gathereth her food in the harvest.</i> | yet she provides her food in the summer, and gathers her food in the harvest. |
| 9 | <i>How long wilt thou sleep, O sluggard? when wilt thou arise out of thy sleep?</i> | How long will You sleep, sluggard? When will You arise from Your sleep? |
| 10 | <i>Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep:</i> | A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep — |

- 11 *So shall thy poverty come as one that travelleth, and thy want as an armed man.* so Your poverty will come like a wanderer, and Your need like an armed man.
- 12 *A naughty person, a wicked man, walketh with a froward mouth.* A worthless person, a wicked man, walks with a perverse mouth.
- 13 *He winketh with his eyes, he speaketh with his feet, he teacheth with his fingers;* He winks with His eyes, He speaks with His feet, He points with His fingers.
- 14 *Frowardness is in his heart, he deviseth mischief continually; he soweth discord.* Perversity is in His heart; He devises mischief continually; He sows discord.
- 15 *Therefore shall his calamity come suddenly; suddenly shall he be broken without remedy.* Therefore His calamity will come suddenly; suddenly He will be broken without remedy.
- 16 *These six things doth the LORD hate: yea, seven are an abomination unto him:* These six things the LORD hates; yes, seven are an abomination to Him:
- 17 *A proud look, a lying tongue, and hands that shed innocent blood,* a proud look, a lying tongue, and hands that shed innocent blood;
- 18 *An heart that deviseth wicked imaginations, feet that be swift in running to mischief,* a heart that devises wicked plans, feet that are swift in running to mischief;
- 19 *A false witness that speaketh lies, and he that soweth discord among brethren.* a false witness who speaks lies, and one who sows discord among brethren.
- 20 *My son, keep thy father's commandment, and forsake not the law of thy mother:* My son, keep Your father's commandment, and do not forsake the law of Your mother.
- 21 *Bind them continually upon thine heart, and tie them about thy neck.* Bind them continually on Your heart; tie them around Your neck.
- 22 *When thou goest, it shall lead thee; when thou sleepest, it shall keep thee; and when thou awakest, it shall talk with thee.* When You walk, it will lead You; when You sleep, it will keep You; and when You awake, it will speak with You.

- 23 *For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light; and reproofs of instruction are the way of life:* For the commandment is a lamp, the law is a light, and reproofs of instruction are the way of life,
- 24 *To keep thee from the evil woman, from the flattery of the tongue of a strange woman.* to keep You from the evil woman, from the flattery of the tongue of a strange woman.
- 25 *Lust not after her beauty in thine heart; neither let her take thee with her eyelids.* Do not lust after her beauty in Your heart, nor let her take You with her eyelids.
- 26 *For by means of a whorish woman a man is brought to a piece of bread: and the adulteress will hunt for the precious life.* For by means of a harlot a man is reduced to a piece of bread, and an adulteress will hunt for the precious life.
- 27 *Can a man take fire in his bosom, and his clothes not be burned?* Can a man take fire to his bosom, and his clothes not be burned?
- 28 *Can one go upon hot coals, and his feet not be burned?* Can one walk on hot coals, and His feet not be burned?
- 29 *So he that goeth in to his neighbour's wife; whosoever toucheth her shall not be innocent.* So is He who goes in to his neighbor's wife; whoever touches her will not be innocent.
- 30 *Men do not despise a thief, if he steal to satisfy his soul when he is hungry;* Men do not despise a thief if He steals to satisfy Himself when He is hungry,
- 31 *But if he be found, he shall restore sevenfold; he shall give all the substance of his house.* but if He is found out, He must restore sevenfold; He must give all the substance of His house.
- 32 *But whoso committeth adultery with a woman lacketh understanding: he that doeth it destroyeth his own soul.* But whoever commits adultery with a woman lacks understanding; he who does so destroys his own soul.
- 33 *A wound and dishonour shall he get; and his reproach shall not be wiped away.* He will get wounds and dishonor, and His reproach will not be wiped away.
- 34 *For jealousy is the rage of a man: therefore he will not spare in the day of vengeance.* For jealousy is the rage of a man; therefore he will not spare in the day of vengeance.

- 35

*He will not regard any ransom;
neither will he rest content, though
thou givest many gifts.*
- He will not accept any ransom, nor
will He be content though You give
many gifts.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 22:26; Prov 17:18; Prov 11:15; Prov 20:16; Gen 44:32-33
- v2 — Prov 18:7; Prov 12:13
- v6 — Prov 20:4; Prov 18:9; Prov 6:9; Prov 13:4; Heb 6:12
- v12 — Matt 12:34; Prov 4:24; 1 Tim 5:13; Prov 16:27
- v16 — Ps 11:5; Prov 8:13; Prov 11:20; Deut 25:16; Prov 17:15
- v17 — Ps 120:2-3; Prov 12:22; Ps 101:5; Isa 1:15; Ps 5:6
- v18 — Gen 6:5; Prov 1:16; Ps 36:4; Rom 3:15; Jer 4:14
- v19 — Prov 19:5; Prov 6:14; Jas 3:18; Prov 19:9; Ps 27:12
- v22 — Ps 119:11; Prov 3:23-24; Ps 119:24; Prov 2:11
- v23 — Ps 119:105; 2 Pet 1:19; Ps 19:8; Prov 15:31; Prov 4:13
- v25 — Matt 5:28; Jas 1:14-15; 2 Kgs 9:30
- v31 — Luke 19:8; Job 20:18; Ex 22:1-4; 2 Sam 12:6; Matt 18:25

Chapter 7

The father describes watching from his window as a young man without sense walks into the trap of the strange woman, who flatters him with her words and leads him to her bed. He is like an ox going to the slaughter; her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death.

- 1

*My son, keep my words, and lay up my
commandments with thee.*
- My son, keep my words, and store up
my commandments with you.
- 2

*Keep my commandments, and live;
and my law as the apple of thine eye.*
- Keep my commandments and live, and
my law as the apple of your eye.
- 3

*Bind them upon thy fingers, write
them upon the table of thine heart.*
- Bind them on your fingers; write them
on the tablet of your heart.
- 4

*Say unto wisdom, Thou art my sister;
and call understanding thy
kinswoman:*
- Say to wisdom, "You are my sister,"
and call understanding your
kinswoman,
- 5

*That they may keep thee from the
strange woman, from the stranger
which flattereth with her words.*
- so that they may keep you from the
strange woman, from the stranger who
flatters with her words.

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| 6 <i>For at the window of my house I
looked through my casement,</i> | For at the window of my house I
looked through my lattice, |
| 7 <i>And beheld among the simple ones, I
discerned among the youths, a young
man void of understanding,</i> | and I saw among the simple ones, I
noticed among the youths, a young
man without understanding, |
| 8 <i>Passing through the street near her
corner; and he went the way to her
house,</i> | passing through the street near her
corner; and he took the path to her
house |
| 9 <i>In the twilight, in the evening, in the
black and dark night:</i> | in the twilight, in the evening, in the
black and dark night. |
| 10 <i>And, behold, there met him a woman
with the attire of an harlot, and subtil
of heart.</i> | And there a woman met him, with the
attire of a harlot and crafty of heart. |
| 11 <i>(She is loud and stubborn; her feet
abide not in her house:</i> | She is loud and stubborn; her feet do
not stay at home. |
| 12 <i>Now is she without, now in the streets,
and lieth in wait at every corner.)</i> | Now she is outside, now in the streets,
and lies in wait at every corner. |
| 13 <i>So she caught him, and kissed him,
and with an impudent face said unto
him,</i> | So she caught him and kissed him, and
with a bold face said to him, |
| 14 <i>I have peace offerings with me; this
day have I payed my vows.</i> | "I have peace offerings with me; today
I have paid my vows. |
| 15 <i>Therefore came I forth to meet thee,
diligently to seek thy face, and I have
found thee.</i> | Therefore I came out to meet you,
diligently to seek your face, and I have
found you. |
| 16 <i>I have decked my bed with coverings
of tapestry, with carved works, with
fine linen of Egypt.</i> | I have decked my bed with coverings
of tapestry, with carved works, with
fine linen of Egypt. |
| 17 <i>I have perfumed my bed with myrrh,
aloes, and cinnamon.</i> | I have perfumed my bed with myrrh,
aloes, and cinnamon. |
| 18 <i>Come, let us take our fill of love until
the morning: let us solace ourselves
with loves.</i> | Come, let us take our fill of love until
morning; let us delight ourselves with
love. |

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| <p>19 <i>For the goodman is not at home, he is gone a long journey:</i></p> <p>20 <i>He hath taken a bag of money with him, and will come home at the day appointed.</i></p> <p>21 <i>With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him.</i></p> <p>22 <i>He goeth after her straightway, as an ox goeth to the slaughter, or as a fool to the correction of the stocks;</i></p> <p>23 <i>Till a dart strike through his liver; as a bird hasteth to the snare, and knoweth not that it is for his life.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Hearken unto me now therefore, O ye children, and attend to the words of my mouth.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Let not thine heart decline to her ways, go not astray in her paths.</i></p> <p>26 <i>For she hath cast down many wounded: yea, many strong men have been slain by her.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death.</i></p> | <p>For the man is not at home; he has gone on a long journey.</p> <p>He has taken a bag of money with him, and will come home on the appointed day."</p> <p>With her smooth speech she caused him to yield; with the flattering of her lips she forced him.</p> <p>He goes after her at once, like an ox going to the slaughter, or like a fool to the correction of the stocks,</p> <p>until an arrow strikes through his liver; like a bird hurrying to the snare, not knowing it would cost his life.</p> <p>Therefore listen to me now, my children, and pay attention to the words of my mouth.</p> <p>Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; do not stray into her paths.</p> <p>For she has cast down many wounded; indeed, many strong men have been slain by her.</p> <p>Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 1:8; Luke 11:28; Rev 1:3; John 14:23; Prov 2:1-7
- v2 — Ps 17:8; 1 John 2:3-4; Lev 18:5; Prov 4:4; John 14:21
- v3 — Deut 11:18-20; Prov 3:3; Deut 6:8-9; Jer 31:33; 2 Cor 3:3
- v4 — Prov 4:6-8; Prov 2:2-4
- v5 — Prov 2:16
- v7 — Prov 6:32
- v10 — 2 Cor 11:2-3; Isa 3:16-24; 1 Tim 2:9; 2 Kgs 9:30; Jer 4:30
- v11 — Prov 9:13; Titus 2:5

v12 — Prov 23:28

v21 — Prov 5:3; Prov 7:5

v25 — Prov 5:8

v27 — Prov 5:5; Prov 9:18

Chapter 8

Wisdom calls aloud at the gates of the city, declaring that she offers truth, counsel, and strength, and that kings reign and princes decree justice by her. She reveals that she was with God before creation, brought forth before the mountains, rejoicing always before Him — and those who find her find life.

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| 1 | <i>Doth not wisdom cry? and understanding put forth her voice?</i> | Does not wisdom cry out, and understanding lift up her voice? |
| 2 | <i>She standeth in the top of high places, by the way in the places of the paths.</i> | She stands on the top of high places, by the way, where the paths meet. |
| 3 | <i>She crieth at the gates, at the entry of the city, at the coming in at the doors.</i> | She cries out by the gates, at the entry of the city, at the coming in at the doors: |
| 4 | <i>Unto you, O men, I call; and my voice is to the sons of man.</i> | "To you, O men, I call, and my voice is to the sons of man. |
| 5 | <i>O ye simple, understand wisdom: and, ye fools, be ye of an understanding heart.</i> | O you simple ones, understand wisdom; and you fools, be of an understanding heart. |
| 6 | <i>Hear; for I will speak of excellent things; and the opening of my lips shall be right things.</i> | Hear, for I will speak of excellent things, and the opening of my lips will be right things. |
| 7 | <i>For my mouth shall speak truth; and wickedness is an abomination to my lips.</i> | For my mouth will speak truth, and wickedness is an abomination to my lips. |
| 8 | <i>All the words of my mouth are in righteousness; there is nothing froward or perverse in them.</i> | All the words of my mouth are in righteousness; there is nothing twisted or perverse in them. |
| 9 | <i>They are all plain to him that understandeth, and right to them that find knowledge.</i> | They are all plain to him who understands, and right to those who find knowledge. |

- 10 *Receive my instruction, and not silver; and knowledge rather than choice gold.* Receive my instruction, and not silver, and knowledge rather than choice gold.
- 11 *For wisdom is better than rubies; and all the things that may be desired are not to be compared to it.* For wisdom is better than rubies, and all the things one may desire cannot be compared to her.
- 12 *I wisdom dwell with prudence, and find out knowledge of witty inventions.* I, Wisdom, dwell with prudence, and find out knowledge of clever inventions.
- 13 *The fear of the LORD is to hate evil: pride, and arrogancy, and the evil way, and the froward mouth, do I hate.* The fear of the LORD is to hate evil; pride and arrogance, the evil way, and the perverse mouth, I hate.
- 14 *Counsel is mine, and sound wisdom: I am understanding; I have strength.* Counsel is mine, and sound wisdom; I am understanding; I have strength.
- 15 *By me kings reign, and princes decree justice.* By me kings reign, and princes decree justice.
- 16 *By me princes rule, and nobles, even all the judges of the earth.* By me princes rule, and nobles, even all the judges of the earth.
- 17 *I love them that love me; and those that seek me early shall find me.* I love those who love me, and those who seek me diligently will find me.
- 18 *Riches and honour are with me; yea, durable riches and righteousness.* Riches and honor are with me, enduring riches and righteousness.
- 19 *My fruit is better than gold, yea, than fine gold; and my revenue than choice silver.* My fruit is better than gold, even fine gold, and my revenue better than choice silver.
- 20 *I lead in the way of righteousness, in the midst of the paths of judgment:* I lead in the way of righteousness, in the midst of the paths of justice,
- 21 *That I may cause those that love me to inherit substance; and I will fill their treasures.* so that I may cause those who love me to inherit wealth, and I will fill their treasures.

- 22 *The LORD possessed me at the beginning of his work, the first of his acts of old.* The LORD possessed me in the beginning of His way, before His works of old.
- 23 *I was set up from everlasting, from the beginning, or ever the earth was.* I was set up from everlasting, from the beginning, before the earth was.
- 24 *When there were no depths, I was brought forth; when there were no fountains abounding with water.* When there were no depths, I was brought forth; when there were no fountains abounding with water.
- 25 *Before the mountains were settled, before the hills was I brought forth:* Before the mountains were settled, before the hills, I was brought forth,
- 26 *While as yet he had not made the earth, nor the fields, nor the highest part of the dust of the world.* while as yet He had not made the earth, nor the fields, nor the beginning of the dust of the world.
- 27 *When he prepared the heavens, I was there: when he set a compass upon the face of the depth:* When He prepared the heavens, I was there; when He set a circle on the face of the deep,
- 28 *When he established the clouds above: when he strengthened the fountains of the deep:* when He established the clouds above, when He strengthened the fountains of the deep,
- 29 *When he gave to the sea his decree, that the waters should not pass his commandment: when he appointed the foundations of the earth:* when He gave to the sea His decree, that the waters should not pass His command, when He appointed the foundations of the earth —
- 30 *Then I was by him, as one brought up with him: and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him;* then I was beside Him, as one brought up with Him; and I was daily His delight, rejoicing always before Him,
- 31 *Rejoicing in the habitable part of his earth; and my delights were with the sons of men.* rejoicing in the habitable part of His earth, and my delights were with the sons of men.
- 32 *Now therefore hearken unto me, O ye children: for blessed are they that keep my ways.* Now therefore, listen to me, my children, for blessed are those who keep my ways.
- 33 *Hear instruction, and be wise, and refuse it not.* Hear instruction and be wise; do not refuse it.

34	<i>Blessed is the man that heareth me, watching daily at my gates, waiting at the posts of my doors.</i>	Blessed is the man who hears me, watching daily at my gates, waiting at the posts of my doors.
35	<i>For whoso findeth me findeth life, and shall obtain favour of the LORD.</i>	For whoever finds me finds life, and will obtain favor from the LORD.
36	<i>But he that sinneth against me wrongeth his own soul: all they that hate me love death.</i>	But He who sins against me wrongs his own soul; all those who hate me love death."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v10 — Prov 2:4-5; Ps 119:127; Ps 119:72; Prov 23:23; Prov 3:13-15
- v11 — Prov 4:5-7; Prov 3:14-15; Prov 16:16; Ps 19:10; Ps 119:127
- v13 — Ps 97:10; Prov 16:6; 1 Sam 2:3; Prov 4:24; 1 Thess 5:22
- v17 — John 14:23; John 14:21; Ps 91:14; Isa 55:6; 1 John 4:19
- v22 — Col 1:17; John 1:1-2; Prov 3:19; Ps 104:24; Job 28:26-28
- v23 — John 17:24; Ps 2:6; Gen 1:26; Mic 5:2; John 17:5
- v27 — Isa 40:22; Job 26:10; Prov 3:19; Ps 136:5; Col 1:16
- v30 — John 1:1-3; John 1:18; Isa 42:1; Matt 3:17; John 16:28
- v32 — Luke 11:28; Ps 119:1-2; Ps 1:1-4; Ps 128:1; Prov 5:7
- v34 — Luke 11:28; Matt 7:24; Prov 3:13; Luke 10:39; Acts 2:42
- v35 — John 3:36; 1 John 5:11-12; Prov 12:2; Phil 3:8; John 17:3
- v36 — Prov 15:32; Prov 1:31; John 15:23-24; 1 Cor 16:22; Prov 20:2

Chapter 9

Wisdom builds her house and sets her table, inviting the simple to turn in and live, while the foolish woman sits at her door and calls to the same passersby with stolen waters and secret bread. Between these two invitations stands the pivotal declaration: the fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.

1	<i>Wisdom hath builded her house, she hath hewn out her seven pillars:</i>	Wisdom has built her house; she has hewn out her seven pillars.
2	<i>She hath killed her beasts; she hath mingled her wine; she hath also furnished her table.</i>	She has slaughtered her beasts; she has mixed her wine; she has also set her table.

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| 3 <i>She hath sent forth her maidens: she crieth upon the highest places of the city,</i> | She has sent out her maidens; she cries out from the highest places of the city, |
| 4 <i>Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither: as for him that wanteth understanding, she saith to him,</i> | "Whoever is simple, let him turn in here." As for him who lacks understanding, she says to Him, |
| 5 <i>Come, eat of my bread, and drink of the wine which I have mingled.</i> | "Come, eat of my bread and drink of the wine I have mixed. |
| 6 <i>Forsake the foolish, and live; and go in the way of understanding.</i> | Forsake foolishness and live; go in the way of understanding." |
| 7 <i>He that reproveth a scorner getteth to himself shame: and he that rebuketh a wicked man getteth himself a blot.</i> | He who corrects a scorner gets shame for himself, and He who rebukes a wicked man gets himself a blot. |
| 8 <i>Reprove not a scorner, lest he hate thee: rebuke a wise man, and he will love thee.</i> | Do not correct a scorner, lest He hate You; rebuke a wise man, and He will love You. |
| 9 <i>Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be yet wiser: teach a just man, and he will increase in learning.</i> | Give instruction to a wise man, and He will be yet wiser; teach a just man, and He will increase in learning. |
| 10 <i>The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom: and the knowledge of the holy is understanding.</i> | The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. |
| 11 <i>For by me thy days shall be multiplied, and the years of thy life shall be increased.</i> | For by me Your days will be multiplied, and years will be added to Your life. |
| 12 <i>If thou be wise, thou shalt be wise for thyself: but if thou scornest, thou alone shalt bear it.</i> | If You are wise, You are wise for Yourself; but if You scorn, You alone will bear it. |
| 13 <i>A foolish woman is clamorous: she is simple, and knoweth nothing.</i> | A foolish woman is clamorous; she is simple and knows nothing. |
| 14 <i>For she sitteth at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city,</i> | For she sits at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city, |

15	<i>To call passengers who go right on their ways:</i>	to call to those who pass by, who go straight on their ways:
16	<i>Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither: and as for him that wanteth understanding, she saith to him,</i>	"Whoever is simple, let him turn in here." And as for Him who lacks understanding, she says to Him,
17	<i>Stolen waters are sweet, and bread eaten in secret is pleasant.</i>	"Stolen waters are sweet, and bread eaten in secret is pleasant."
18	<i>But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell.</i>	But He does not know that the dead are there, that her guests are in the depths of hell.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 16:18; Rev 3:12; Eph 2:20-22; 1 Kgs 7:2-3; 1 Pet 2:5-6
- v2 — Matt 22:3-14; Isa 25:6; Luke 14:16-17
- v5 — John 6:27; Song 5:1
- v6 — Prov 13:20; Prov 4:11
- v7 — Prov 15:12; Prov 23:9
- v8 — Ps 141:5; Prov 13:18; Prov 23:9; Prov 15:12; Matt 7:6
- v9 — Prov 1:5; Matt 13:11-12; 1 John 5:13; Prov 25:12; 1 John 2:20-21
- v10 — Ps 111:10; Job 28:28; Prov 1:7; Eccl 12:13; Prov 2:5
- v11 — Prov 10:27; Prov 3:2; Prov 3:16; Deut 6:2
- v12 — Job 22:2-3; Ezek 18:20; 2 Pet 3:3-4
- v13 — Prov 7:11
- v17 — Prov 20:17; Prov 23:31-32

Chapter 10

Contrasting proverbs address the difference between the wise son and the foolish, the hand of the diligent and the hand of the slack, the mouth of the righteous and the mouth of the wicked. The chapter sets the dominant pattern for the next twenty chapters: righteousness brings life, wickedness brings ruin.

1	<i>The proverbs of Solomon. A wise son maketh a glad father: but a foolish son is the heaviness of his mother.</i>	The proverbs of Solomon. A wise son makes a glad father; but a foolish son is the heaviness of his mother.
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| 2 | <i>Treasures of wickedness profit nothing; but righteousness delivereth from death.</i> | Treasures of wickedness profit nothing; but righteousness delivers from death. |
| 3 | <i>The LORD will not suffer the soul of the righteous to famish: but he casteth away the substance of the wicked.</i> | The LORD will not allow the soul of the righteous to famish; but he casts away the substance of the wicked. |
| 4 | <i>He becometh poor that dealeth with a slack hand: but the hand of the diligent maketh rich.</i> | He who deals with a slack hand becomes poor; but the hand of the diligent makes rich. |
| 5 | <i>He that gathereth in summer is a wise son: but he that sleepeth in harvest is a son that causeth shame.</i> | He who gathers in summer is a wise son; but he who sleeps in harvest is a son who causes shame. |
| 6 | <i>Blessings are upon the head of the just: but violence covereth the mouth of the wicked.</i> | Blessings are on the head of the just; but violence covers the mouth of the wicked. |
| 7 | <i>The memory of the just is blessed: but the name of the wicked shall rot.</i> | The memory of the just is blessed; but the name of the wicked will rot. |
| 8 | <i>The wise in heart will receive commandments: but a prating fool shall fall.</i> | The wise in heart will receive commandments; but a babbling fool will fall. |
| 9 | <i>He that walketh uprightly walketh surely: but he that perverteth his ways shall be known.</i> | He who walks uprightly walks securely; but he who perverts his ways will be found out. |
| 10 | <i>He that winketh with the eye causeth sorrow: but a prating fool shall fall.</i> | He who winks with the eye causes sorrow; but a babbling fool will fall. |
| 11 | <i>The mouth of a righteous man is a well of life: but violence covereth the mouth of the wicked.</i> | The mouth of a righteous man is a well of life; but violence covers the mouth of the wicked. |
| 12 | <i>Hatred stirreth up strifes: but love covereth all sins.</i> | Hatred stirs up strife; but love covers all sins. |
| 13 | <i>In the lips of him that hath understanding wisdom is found: but a rod is for the back of him that is void of understanding.</i> | Wisdom is found on the lips of him who has understanding; but a rod is for the back of him who lacks understanding. |

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| 14 <i>Wise men lay up knowledge: but the mouth of the foolish is near destruction.</i> | Wise men store up knowledge; but the mouth of the foolish is near destruction. |
| 15 <i>The rich man's wealth is his strong city: the destruction of the poor is their poverty.</i> | The rich man's wealth is his strong city; the destruction of the poor is their poverty. |
| 16 <i>The labour of the righteous tendeth to life: the fruit of the wicked to sin.</i> | The labor of the righteous leads to life; the fruit of the wicked to sin. |
| 17 <i>He is in the way of life that keepeth instruction: but he that refuseth reproof erreth.</i> | He who keeps instruction is in the way of life; but he who refuses correction goes astray. |
| 18 <i>He that hideth hatred with lying lips, and he that uttereth a slander, is a fool.</i> | He who hides hatred with lying lips, and he who utters slander, is a fool. |
| 19 <i>In the multitude of words there wanteth not sin: but he that refraineth his lips is wise.</i> | In the multitude of words sin is not lacking; but he who restrains his lips is wise. |
| 20 <i>The tongue of the just is as choice silver: the heart of the wicked is little worth.</i> | The tongue of the just is like choice silver; the heart of the wicked is of little worth. |
| 21 <i>The lips of the righteous feed many: but fools die for want of wisdom.</i> | The lips of the righteous feed many; but fools die for lack of wisdom. |
| 22 <i>The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich, and he addeth no sorrow with it.</i> | The blessing of the LORD makes rich, and He adds no sorrow with it. |
| 23 <i>It is as sport to a fool to do mischief: but a man of understanding hath wisdom.</i> | It is as sport to a fool to do mischief; but a man of understanding has wisdom. |
| 24 <i>The fear of the wicked, it shall come upon him: but the desire of the righteous shall be granted.</i> | The fear of the wicked will come on him; but the desire of the righteous will be granted. |
| 25 <i>As the whirlwind passeth, so is the wicked no more: but the righteous is an everlasting foundation.</i> | As the whirlwind passes, so the wicked are no more; but the righteous have an everlasting foundation. |

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| 26 | <i>As vinegar to the teeth, and as smoke to the eyes, so is the sluggard to them that send him.</i> | As vinegar to the teeth and as smoke to the eyes, so is the sluggard to those who send him. |
| 27 | <i>The fear of the LORD prolongeth days: but the years of the wicked shall be shortened.</i> | The fear of the LORD prolongs days; but the years of the wicked will be shortened. |
| 28 | <i>The hope of the righteous shall be gladness: but the expectation of the wicked shall perish.</i> | The hope of the righteous will be gladness; but the expectation of the wicked will perish. |
| 29 | <i>The way of the LORD is strength to the upright: but destruction shall be to the workers of iniquity.</i> | The way of the LORD is strength to the upright; but destruction will be to the workers of iniquity. |
| 30 | <i>The righteous shall never be removed: but the wicked shall not inhabit the earth.</i> | The righteous will never be removed; but the wicked will not inhabit the earth. |
| 31 | <i>The mouth of the just bringeth forth wisdom: but the froward tongue shall be cut out.</i> | The mouth of the just brings forth wisdom; but the perverse tongue will be cut out. |
| 32 | <i>The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable: but the mouth of the wicked speaketh frowardness.</i> | The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable; but the mouth of the wicked speaks perversity. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Prov 1:1; Prov 29:15; Prov 17:25; Prov 29:3; Prov 23:15-16
v3 — Ps 37:3; Matt 6:30-33; Ps 37:25; Ps 34:9-10; Ps 33:19
v4 — Prov 20:4; Prov 19:15; Prov 21:5; Prov 13:4; Prov 6:6-11
v7 — Ps 112:6; Luke 1:48; Mark 14:9; Ps 109:13; 2 Chr 24:16
v9 — Prov 28:18; Ps 26:11-12; Matt 10:26; Isa 33:15-16; 1 Cor 4:5
v11 — Prov 13:14; Eph 4:29; Prov 10:20-21; Prov 18:4; Prov 10:6
v12 — 1 Pet 4:8; 1 Cor 13:4-7; Prov 17:9; Prov 15:18; Jas 5:20
v17 — 2 Pet 1:5-11; Prov 15:10; Prov 5:12; Luke 11:28; Prov 6:23
v19 — Jas 1:19; Jas 3:2; Prov 17:27-28; Eccl 10:13-14; Eccl 5:3
v22 — Ps 107:38; Gen 26:12; 1 Sam 2:7-8; Gen 24:35; Gen 12:2
v24 — Ps 145:19; Isa 66:4; Matt 5:6; 1 John 5:14-15; Job 15:21
v30 — Ps 37:22; Ps 125:1; Ps 37:28-29; Ps 37:9-10; Prov 2:21-22

Chapter 11

Contrasting proverbs address the destruction of the wicked and the deliverance of the righteous, the ruin that pride brings and the wisdom that humility preserves. Repeated themes include the power of integrity versus the treachery of the unfaithful, and the generosity that leads to increase versus the withholding that leads to want.

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| 1 | <i>A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight.</i> | A false balance is an abomination to the LORD; but a just weight is His delight. |
| 2 | <i>When pride cometh, then cometh shame: but with the lowly is wisdom.</i> | When pride comes, then comes shame; but with the lowly is wisdom. |
| 3 | <i>The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them.</i> | The integrity of the upright will guide them; but the perverseness of transgressors will destroy them. |
| 4 | <i>Riches profit not in the day of wrath: but righteousness delivereth from death.</i> | Riches do not profit in the day of wrath; but righteousness delivers from death. |
| 5 | <i>The righteousness of the perfect shall direct his way: but the wicked shall fall by his own wickedness.</i> | The righteousness of the blameless will direct his way; but the wicked will fall by his own wickedness. |
| 6 | <i>The righteousness of the upright shall deliver them: but transgressors shall be taken in their own naughtiness.</i> | The righteousness of the upright will deliver them; but transgressors will be caught in their own wickedness. |
| 7 | <i>When a wicked man dieth, his expectation shall perish: and the hope of unjust men perisheth.</i> | When a wicked man dies, his expectation will perish, and the hope of unjust men perishes. |
| 8 | <i>The righteous is delivered out of trouble, and the wicked cometh in his stead.</i> | The righteous is delivered out of trouble, and the wicked takes his place. |
| 9 | <i>An hypocrite with his mouth destroyeth his neighbour: but through knowledge shall the just be delivered.</i> | A hypocrite with his mouth destroys his neighbor; but through knowledge the just will be delivered. |
| 10 | <i>When it goeth well with the righteous, the city rejoiceth: and when the wicked perish, there is shouting.</i> | When it goes well with the righteous, the city rejoices, and when the wicked perish, there is shouting. |

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| 11 | <i>By the blessing of the upright the city is exalted: but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked.</i> | By the blessing of the upright the city is exalted; but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked. |
| 12 | <i>He that is void of wisdom despiseth his neighbour: but a man of understanding holdeth his peace.</i> | He who lacks wisdom despises his neighbor; but a man of understanding holds his peace. |
| 13 | <i>A talebearer revealeth secrets: but he that is of a faithful spirit concealeth the matter.</i> | A talebearer reveals secrets; but he who is of a faithful spirit conceals the matter. |
| 14 | <i>Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.</i> | Where there is no counsel, the people fall; but in the multitude of counselors there is safety. |
| 15 | <i>He that is surety for a stranger shall smart for it: and he that hateth suretiship is sure.</i> | He who is surety for a stranger will suffer for it, but he who hates being surety is secure. |
| 16 | <i>A gracious woman retaineth honour: and strong men retain riches.</i> | A gracious woman retains honor, and strong men retain riches. |
| 17 | <i>The merciful man doeth good to his own soul: but he that is cruel troubleth his own flesh.</i> | The merciful man does good for his own soul; but he who is cruel troubles his own flesh. |
| 18 | <i>The wicked worketh a deceitful work: but to him that soweth righteousness shall be a sure reward.</i> | The wicked does a deceitful work; but to him who sows righteousness there will be a sure reward. |
| 19 | <i>As righteousness tendeth to life: so he that pursueth evil pursueth it to his own death.</i> | As righteousness leads to life, so he who pursues evil pursues it to his own death. |
| 20 | <i>They that are of a froward heart are abomination to the LORD: but such as are upright in their way are his delight.</i> | Those who are of a perverse heart are an abomination to the LORD; but those who are upright in their way are His delight. |
| 21 | <i>Though hand join in hand, the wicked shall not be unpunished: but the seed of the righteous shall be delivered.</i> | Though hand join in hand, the wicked will not be unpunished; but the seed of the righteous will be delivered. |

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| 22 <i>As a jewel of gold in a swine's snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion.</i> | Like a jewel of gold in a swine's snout is a beautiful woman without discretion. |
| 23 <i>The desire of the righteous is only good: but the expectation of the wicked is wrath.</i> | The desire of the righteous is only good; but the expectation of the wicked is wrath. |
| 24 <i>There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty.</i> | There is one who scatters, yet increases more; and there is one who withholds more than is right, but it tends to poverty. |
| 25 <i>The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself.</i> | The generous soul will be made rich, and he who waters will himself be watered. |
| 26 <i>He that withholdeth corn, the people shall curse him: but blessing shall be upon the head of him that selleth it.</i> | The people will curse him who withholds grain; but blessing will be on the head of him who sells it. |
| 27 <i>He that diligently seeketh good procureth favour: but he that seeketh mischief, it shall come unto him.</i> | He who diligently seeks good procures favor; but he who seeks mischief, it will come to him. |
| 28 <i>He that trusteth in his riches shall fall: but the righteous shall flourish as a branch.</i> | He who trusts in his riches will fall; but the righteous will flourish like a branch. |
| 29 <i>He that troubleth his own house shall inherit the wind: and the fool shall be servant to the wise of heart.</i> | He who troubles his own house will inherit the wind, and the fool will be servant to the wise of heart. |
| 30 <i>The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise.</i> | The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life, and he who wins souls is wise. |
| 31 <i>Behold, the righteous shall be recompensed in the earth: much more the wicked and the sinner.</i> | If the righteous are recompensed on the earth, how much more the wicked and the sinner! |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 25:13-16; Prov 16:11; Prov 20:23; Lev 19:35-36; Prov 20:10
v2 — Prov 29:23; Prov 16:18-19; Prov 15:33; Luke 18:14; Prov 18:12
v3 — Prov 13:6; Prov 28:18; Ps 25:21; Ps 26:1; Prov 19:3
v4 — Zeph 1:18; Prov 10:2; Gen 7:1; Ezek 7:19; 1 Tim 4:8
v8 — Dan 6:23-24; Prov 21:18; Esth 7:9-10; Isa 43:3-4
v13 — Prov 20:19; Lev 19:16; Prov 25:9; 1 Tim 5:13; Prov 26:20-22
v14 — Prov 24:6; Prov 15:22; Prov 20:18; Prov 16:22; 1 Kgs 12:1-19
v18 — Gal 6:8-9; Eccl 10:8; Hos 10:12-13; Jas 3:18; Ps 126:5-6
v21 — Ps 112:1-2; Acts 2:39; Jer 32:39; Ps 37:26; Prov 16:5
v24 — Prov 19:17; Luke 6:38; Deut 15:10; Ps 112:9; Eccl 11:6
v25 — Matt 5:7; 2 Cor 9:6-9; Isa 58:7-11; Matt 25:34-35; Isa 32:8
v30 — Dan 12:3; Jas 5:20; 1 Cor 9:19-23; 1 Thess 2:19; Prov 3:18

Chapter 12

Contrasting proverbs address the value of accepting correction, the faithfulness of the righteous versus the deceit of the wicked, and the power of words to wound or to heal. The diligent hand rules while the slack hand serves, and the way of a fool is right in his own eyes.

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| 1 | <i>Whoso loveth instruction loveth knowledge: but he that hateth reproof is brutish.</i> | Whoever loves instruction loves knowledge; but he who hates correction is brutish. |
| 2 | <i>A good man obtaineth favour of the LORD: but a man of wicked devices will he condemn.</i> | A good man obtains favor from the LORD; but a man of wicked devices he will condemn. |
| 3 | <i>A man shall not be established by wickedness: but the root of the righteous shall not be moved.</i> | A man will not be established by wickedness; but the root of the righteous will not be moved. |
| 4 | <i>A virtuous woman is a crown to her husband: but she that maketh ashamed is as rottenness in his bones.</i> | A virtuous woman is a crown to her husband; but she who causes shame is like rottenness in His bones. |
| 5 | <i>The thoughts of the righteous are right: but the counsels of the wicked are deceit.</i> | The thoughts of the righteous are right; but the counsels of the wicked are deceit. |
| 6 | <i>The words of the wicked are to lie in wait for blood: but the mouth of the upright shall deliver them.</i> | The words of the wicked lie in wait for blood; but the mouth of the upright will deliver them. |

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| 7 <i>The wicked are overthrown, and are not: but the house of the righteous shall stand.</i> | The wicked are overthrown and are no more; but the house of the righteous will stand. |
| 8 <i>A man shall be commended according to his wisdom: but he that is of a perverse heart shall be despised.</i> | A man will be commended according to his wisdom; but he who is of a perverse heart will be despised. |
| 9 <i>He that is despised, and hath a servant, is better than he that honoureth himself, and lacketh bread.</i> | He who is despised yet has a servant is better than he who honors himself yet lacks bread. |
| 10 <i>A righteous man regardeth the life of his animal: but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel.</i> | A righteous man regards the life of his animal; but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel. |
| 11 <i>He that tilleth his land shall be satisfied with bread: but he that followeth vain persons is void of understanding.</i> | He who tills his land will be satisfied with bread; but he who follows worthless persons lacks understanding. |
| 12 <i>The wicked desireth the net of evil men: but the root of the righteous yieldeth fruit.</i> | The wicked desire the spoil of evil men; but the root of the righteous yields fruit. |
| 13 <i>The wicked is snared by the transgression of his lips: but the just shall come out of trouble.</i> | The wicked is snared by the transgression of his lips; but the just will come out of trouble. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — Crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. Where "iniquity" is the twisted nature, transgression is the specific act of stepping over the boundary.

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| 14 <i>A man shall be satisfied with good by the fruit of his mouth: and the recompence of a man's hands shall be rendered unto him.</i> | A man will be satisfied with good by the fruit of his mouth, and the recompense of a man's hands will be repaid to him. |
| 15 <i>The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise.</i> | The way of a fool is right in his own eyes; but he who listens to counsel is wise. |
| 16 <i>A fool's wrath is presently known: but a prudent man covereth shame.</i> | A fool's wrath is known at once; but a prudent man covers shame. |

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| 17 | <i>An honest witness delivereth true testimony: but a false witness deceit.</i> | An honest witness delivers true testimony; but a false witness, deceit. |
| 18 | <i>There is that speaketh like the piercings of a sword: but the tongue of the wise is health.</i> | There is one who speaks like the piercings of a sword; but the tongue of the wise brings health. |
| 19 | <i>The lip of truth shall be established for ever: but a lying tongue is but for a moment.</i> | The lip of truth will be established forever; but a lying tongue is only for a moment. |
| 20 | <i>Deceit is in the heart of them that imagine evil: but to the counsellors of peace is joy.</i> | Deceit is in the heart of those who plot evil; but to the counselors of peace there is joy. |
| 21 | <i>There shall no evil happen to the just: but the wicked shall be filled with mischief.</i> | No evil will happen to the just; but the wicked will be filled with mischief. |
| 22 | <i>Lying lips are abomination to the LORD: but they that deal truly are his delight.</i> | Lying lips are an abomination to the LORD; but those who deal truly are His delight. |
| 23 | <i>A prudent man concealeth knowledge: but the heart of fools proclaimeth foolishness.</i> | A prudent man conceals knowledge; but the heart of fools proclaims foolishness. |
| 24 | <i>The hand of the diligent shall bear rule: but the slothful shall be under tribute.</i> | The hand of the diligent will rule; but the slothful will be under tribute. |
| 25 | <i>Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it stoop: but a good word maketh it glad.</i> | Heaviness in the heart of a man makes it stoop; but a good word makes it glad. |
| 26 | <i>The righteous is more excellent than his neighbour: but the way of the wicked seduceth them.</i> | The righteous is more excellent than his neighbor; but the way of the wicked seduces them. |
| 27 | <i>The slothful man roasteth not that which he took in hunting: but the substance of a diligent man is precious.</i> | The slothful man does not roast what he has caught; but the substance of a diligent man is precious. |

- 28 *In the way of righteousness is life; and in the pathway thereof there is no death.* In the way of righteousness is life, and in its pathway there is no death.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 15:10; Prov 9:7-8; Ps 119:97-100; Prov 18:1; Prov 5:12-13
- v3 — Prov 10:25; Eph 3:17; Col 2:7; Prov 12:12
- v4 — Prov 31:10-25; Prov 14:30; Prov 14:1; Prov 21:19; 1 Cor 11:11
- v11 — Prov 28:19; Prov 14:23; 1 Thess 4:11-12; Ps 128:2; Eph 4:28
- v13 — Prov 21:23; Prov 11:8; Ps 64:8; Dan 6:24; Prov 6:2
- v14 — Prov 18:20-21; Isa 3:10-11; Prov 13:2; Ps 63:5; Prov 15:23
- v15 — Prov 3:7; Prov 14:16; Prov 26:12; Prov 19:20; Prov 16:25
- v16 — Prov 29:11; Jas 1:19; Prov 10:12; Prov 25:28; Prov 17:9
- v18 — Prov 16:24; Prov 15:4; Ps 57:4; Jas 3:6-8; Ps 52:2
- v22 — Ps 5:6; Prov 11:20; Rev 22:15; Prov 6:16-17; Jer 9:24
- v25 — Prov 16:24; Prov 15:13; Prov 17:22; Isa 50:4; Prov 15:23
- v28 — 3 John 1:11; Rom 5:21; Ezek 18:20-24; Titus 2:11-12; Prov 11:19

Chapter 13

Contrasting proverbs address the guarding of the mouth, the fruit of diligence, the emptiness of wealth gotten by vanity, and the difference between the wise who receive instruction and the fools who despise it. Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but a desire fulfilled is a tree of life.

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| 1 <i>A wise son heareth his father's instruction: but a scorner heareth not rebuke.</i> | A wise son hears his father's instruction; but a scorner does not listen to rebuke. |
| 2 <i>A man shall eat good by the fruit of his mouth: but the soul of the transgressors shall eat violence.</i> | A man will eat good by the fruit of his mouth; but the soul of the transgressors will eat violence. |
| 3 <i>He that keepeth his mouth keepeth his life: but he that openeth wide his lips shall have destruction.</i> | He who guards his mouth preserves his life; but he who opens wide his lips will have destruction. |
| 4 <i>The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing: but the soul of the diligent shall be made fat.</i> | The soul of the sluggard desires, and has nothing; but the soul of the diligent will be made rich. |

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| 5 <i>A righteous man hateth lying: but a wicked man is loathsome, and cometh to shame.</i> | A righteous man hates lying; but a wicked man is loathsome and comes to shame. |
| 6 <i>Righteousness keepeth him that is upright in the way: but wickedness overthroweth the sinner.</i> | Righteousness keeps him who is upright in the way; but wickedness overthrows the sinner. |
| 7 <i>There is that maketh himself rich, yet hath nothing: there is that maketh himself poor, yet hath great riches.</i> | There is one who makes himself rich, yet has nothing; there is one who makes himself poor, yet has great riches. |
| 8 <i>The ransom of a man's life are his riches: but the poor heareth not rebuke.</i> | The ransom of a man's life is his riches; but the poor does not hear rebuke. |
| 9 <i>The light of the righteous rejoiceth: but the lamp of the wicked shall be put out.</i> | The light of the righteous rejoices; but the lamp of the wicked will be put out. |
| 10 <i>Only by pride cometh contention: but with the well advised is wisdom.</i> | Only by pride comes contention; but with the well-advised is wisdom. |
| 11 <i>Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished: but he that gathereth by labour shall increase.</i> | Wealth gotten by vanity will be diminished; but he who gathers by labor will increase. |
| 12 <i>Hope deferred maketh the heart sick: but when the desire cometh, it is a tree of life.</i> | Hope deferred makes the heart sick; but when the desire comes, it is a tree of life. |
| 13 <i>Whoso despiseth the word shall be destroyed: but he that feareth the commandment shall be rewarded.</i> | Whoever despises the word will be destroyed; but he who fears the commandment will be rewarded. |
| 14 <i>The law of the wise is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death.</i> | The law of the wise is a fountain of life, to turn one from the snares of death. |
| 15 <i>Good understanding giveth favour: but the way of transgressors is hard.</i> | Good understanding gives favor; but the way of transgressors is hard. |

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| 16 <i>Every prudent man dealeth with knowledge: but a fool layeth open his folly.</i> | Every prudent man acts with knowledge; but a fool lays open his folly. |
| 17 <i>A wicked messenger falleth into mischief: but a faithful ambassador is health.</i> | A wicked messenger falls into mischief; but a faithful ambassador brings health. |
| 18 <i>Poverty and shame shall be to him that refuseth instruction: but he that regardeth reproof shall be honoured.</i> | Poverty and shame will come to him who refuses instruction; but he who heeds correction will be honored. |
| 19 <i>The desire accomplished is sweet to the soul: but it is abomination to fools to depart from evil.</i> | A desire accomplished is sweet to the soul; but it is an abomination to fools to depart from evil. |
| 20 <i>He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.</i> | He who walks with wise men will be wise; but a companion of fools will be destroyed. |
| 21 <i>Evil pursueth sinners: but to the righteous good shall be repayed.</i> | Evil pursues sinners; but to the righteous good will be repaid. |
| 22 <i>A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children: and the wealth of the sinner is laid up for the just.</i> | A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children, and the wealth of the sinner is stored up for the just. |
| 23 <i>Much food is in the tillage of the poor: but there is that is destroyed for want of judgment.</i> | Much food is in the tillage of the poor; but there is one who is destroyed for lack of judgment. |
| 24 <i>He that spareth his rod hateth his son: but he that loveth him chasteneth him betimes.</i> | He who spares his rod hates his son; but he who loves him disciplines him early. |
| 25 <i>The righteous eateth to the satisfying of his soul: but the belly of the wicked shall want.</i> | The righteous eats to the satisfying of his soul; but the belly of the wicked will want. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Prov 15:5; Prov 9:7-8; Prov 15:20; Prov 10:1; Prov 4:1-14

v2 — Prov 12:14; Prov 18:20; Prov 10:11; Prov 1:31; Ps 140:11

v3 — Prov 21:23; Prov 18:21; Prov 18:7; Jas 3:2-12; Matt 12:36-37
v4 — Prov 12:24; Prov 12:11; 2 Pet 1:5-11; Prov 2:2-9; Prov 10:4
v7 — Rev 3:17; Luke 18:11-14; Prov 11:24; Prov 12:9; Luke 12:21
v11 — Prov 20:21; Prov 10:2; Jas 5:1-5; Prov 28:8; Job 27:16-17
v12 — John 16:22; Prov 13:19; Ps 119:81-83; Ps 17:15; Prov 11:30
v13 — Num 15:31; 2 Chr 36:16; Ps 119:165; 2 John 1:8; Ezek 20:16
v20 — 1 Cor 15:33-34; Prov 15:31; Prov 9:6; 2 Cor 6:14-18; Ps 119:63
v21 — Ps 32:10; Isa 3:10-11; Rom 2:7-10; Prov 13:13; Gen 4:7
v22 — Eccl 2:26; Job 27:16-17; Prov 28:8; Ps 37:25; Ps 112:2
v24 — Prov 29:17; Prov 23:13-14; Prov 29:15; Prov 19:18; Heb 12:6-8

Chapter 14

Contrasting proverbs address the wise woman who builds her house versus the foolish woman who tears hers down, the way that seems right to a man but ends in death, and the fear of the LORD as a fountain of life. The chapter warns against envy, hasty anger, and contempt for the poor.

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| <p>¹ <i>Every wise woman buildeth her house: but the foolish plucketh it down with her hands.</i></p> | <p>Every wise woman builds her house; but the foolish plucks it down with her own hands.</p> |
| <p>² <i>He that walketh in his uprightness feareth the LORD: but he that is perverse in his ways despiseth him.</i></p> | <p>He who walks in his uprightness fears the LORD; but He who is perverse in his ways despises him.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>In the mouth of the foolish is a rod of pride: but the lips of the wise shall preserve them.</i></p> | <p>In the mouth of the foolish is a rod of pride; but the lips of the wise will preserve them.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>Where no oxen are, the crib is clean: but much increase is by the strength of the ox.</i></p> | <p>Where there are no oxen, the stall is clean; but much increase comes by the strength of the ox.</p> |
| <p>⁵ <i>A faithful witness will not lie: but a false witness will utter lies.</i></p> | <p>A faithful witness will not lie; but a false witness will utter lies.</p> |
| <p>⁶ <i>A scorner seeketh wisdom, and findeth it not: but knowledge is easy unto him that understandeth.</i></p> | <p>A scorner seeks wisdom and does not find it; but knowledge is easy to Him who understands.</p> |
| <p>⁷ <i>Go from the presence of a foolish man, when thou perceivest not in him the lips of knowledge.</i></p> | <p>Go from the presence of a foolish man when You do not see in Him the lips of knowledge.</p> |

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| 8 <i>The wisdom of the prudent is to understand his way: but the folly of fools is deceit.</i> | The wisdom of the prudent is to understand His way; but the folly of fools is deceit. |
| 9 <i>Fools make a mock at sin: but among the righteous there is favour.</i> | Fools make a mock of sin; but among the righteous there is favor. |
| 10 <i>The heart knoweth his own bitterness; and a stranger doth not intermeddle with his joy.</i> | The heart knows its own bitterness, and a stranger does not share in its joy. |
| 11 <i>The house of the wicked shall be overthrown: but the tabernacle of the upright shall flourish.</i> | The house of the wicked will be overthrown; but the tabernacle of the upright will flourish. |
| 12 <i>There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death.</i> | There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the ways of death. |
| 13 <i>Even in laughter the heart is sorrowful; and the end of that mirth is heaviness.</i> | Even in laughter the heart is sorrowful, and the end of that mirth is heaviness. |
| 14 <i>The backslider in heart shall be filled with his own ways: and a good man shall be satisfied from himself.</i> | The backslider in heart will be filled with his own ways, and a good man will be satisfied from himself. |
| 15 <i>The simple believeth every word: but the prudent man looketh well to his going.</i> | The simple believes every word; but the prudent man looks well to his going. |
| 16 <i>A wise man feareth, and departeth from evil: but the fool rageth, and is confident.</i> | A wise man fears and departs from evil; but the fool rages and is confident. |
| 17 <i>He that is soon angry dealeth foolishly: and a man of wicked devices is hated.</i> | He who is soon angry deals foolishly, and a man of wicked devices is hated. |
| 18 <i>The simple inherit folly: but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.</i> | The simple inherit folly; but the prudent are crowned with knowledge. |
| 19 <i>The evil bow before the good; and the wicked at the gates of the righteous.</i> | The evil bow before the good, and the wicked at the gates of the righteous. |

- 20 *The poor is hated even of his own neighbour: but the rich hath many friends.* The poor is hated even by his own neighbor; but the rich has many friends.
- 21 *He that despiseth his neighbour sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.* He who despises his neighbor sins; but he who has mercy on the poor, happy is he.
- 22 *Do they not err that devise evil? but mercy and truth shall be to them that devise good.* Do they not err who devise evil? But mercy and truth will be to those who devise good.
- 23 *In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury.* In all labor there is profit; but the talk of the lips leads only to poverty.
- 24 *The crown of the wise is their riches: but the foolishness of fools is folly.* The crown of the wise is their riches; but the foolishness of fools is folly.
- 25 *A true witness delivereth souls: but a deceitful witness speaketh lies.* A true witness delivers souls; but a deceitful witness speaks lies.
- 26 *In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence: and his children shall have a place of refuge.* In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence, and His children will have a place of refuge.
- 27 *The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death.* The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to turn one from the snares of death.
- 28 *In the multitude of people is the king's honour: but in the want of people is the destruction of the prince.* In the multitude of people is the king's honor; but in the lack of people is the destruction of the prince.
- 29 *He that is slow to wrath is of great understanding: but he that is hasty of spirit exalteth folly.* He who is slow to wrath is of great understanding; but he who is hasty of spirit exalts folly.
- 30 *A sound heart is the life of the flesh: but envy the rottenness of the bones.* A sound heart is the life of the flesh; but envy is the rottenness of the bones.
- 31 *He that oppresseth the poor reproacheth his Maker: but he that honoureth him hath mercy on the poor.* He who oppresses the poor reproaches his Maker; but he who honors him has mercy on the poor.

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| 32 | <i>The wicked is driven away in his wickedness: but the righteous hath hope in his death.</i> | The wicked is driven away in his wickedness; but the righteous has hope in his death. |
| 33 | <i>Wisdom resteth in the heart of him that hath understanding: but that which is in the midst of fools is made known.</i> | Wisdom rests in the heart of him who has understanding; but what is in the midst of fools is made known. |
| 34 | <i>Righteousness exalteth a nation: but sin is a reproach to any people.</i> | Righteousness exalts a nation; but sin is a reproach to any people. |
| 35 | <i>The king's favour is toward a wise servant: but his wrath is against him that causeth shame.</i> | The king's favor is toward a wise servant; but his wrath is against him who causes shame. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Prov 31:10-31; Prov 24:3-4; Prov 21:9; Prov 21:19; Ruth 4:11
v7 — Prov 13:20; Prov 9:6; Eph 5:11; 1 Cor 5:11; Prov 19:27
v12 — Prov 16:25; Matt 7:13-14; Prov 12:15; Gal 6:3; Luke 13:24
v14 — Gal 6:8; Prov 12:14; Heb 3:12; Jer 8:5; Jer 2:19
v15 — Eph 5:17; Prov 14:8; 1 John 4:1; Prov 4:26; Prov 27:12
v17 — Prov 14:29; Prov 29:22; Eccl 7:9; Jas 1:19; Prov 15:18
v23 — Prov 28:19; Prov 12:24; 2 Thess 3:10-12; Eccl 5:3; Heb 6:10-11
v26 — Prov 19:23; Jer 32:39-40; Ps 115:13-14; Prov 18:10; Prov 3:7-8
v29 — Jas 1:19; Eccl 7:9; Prov 14:17; Prov 15:18; Prov 16:32
v30 — Prov 17:22; Job 5:2; Prov 3:8; Prov 4:23; Prov 12:4
v31 — Prov 22:2; Prov 22:16; Prov 17:5; Prov 19:17; 1 John 4:21
v34 — Ps 107:34; Deut 28:1-68; Deut 29:18-28; Hos 13:1; Deut 4:6-8

Chapter 15

Contrasting proverbs address the power of the tongue — a soft answer turns away wrath, but harsh words stir up anger — and the eyes of the LORD that are in every place, watching the evil and the good. Better is a little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure with trouble.

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| 1 | <i>A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger.</i> | A soft answer turns away wrath; but grievous words stir up anger. |
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| 2 <i>The tongue of the wise useth knowledge aright: but the mouth of fools poureth out foolishness.</i> | The tongue of the wise uses knowledge rightly; but the mouth of fools pours out foolishness. |
| 3 <i>The eyes of the LORD are in every place, beholding the evil and the good.</i> | The eyes of the LORD are in every place, watching the evil and the good. |
| 4 <i>A wholesome tongue is a tree of life: but perverseness therein is a breach in the spirit.</i> | A wholesome tongue is a tree of life; but perverseness in it is a breach in the spirit. |
| 5 <i>A fool despiseth his father's instruction: but he that regardeth reproof is prudent.</i> | A fool despises His father's instruction; but He who heeds correction is prudent. |
| 6 <i>In the house of the righteous is much treasure: but in the revenues of the wicked is trouble.</i> | In the house of the righteous is much treasure; but in the revenues of the wicked is trouble. |
| 7 <i>The lips of the wise disperse knowledge: but the heart of the foolish doeth not so.</i> | The lips of the wise spread knowledge; but the heart of the foolish does not do so. |
| 8 <i>The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD: but the prayer of the upright is his delight.</i> | The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD; but the prayer of the upright is His delight. |
| 9 <i>The way of the wicked is an abomination unto the LORD: but he loveth him that followeth after righteousness.</i> | The way of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD; but He loves Him who follows after righteousness. |
| 10 <i>Correction is grievous unto him that forsaketh the way: and he that hateth reproof shall die.</i> | Correction is grievous to Him who forsakes the way, and He who hates correction will die. |
| 11 <i>Hell and destruction are before the LORD: how much more then the hearts of the children of men?</i> | Hell and destruction are before the LORD; how much more then the hearts of the children of men? |
| 12 <i>A scorner loveth not one that reproveth him: neither will he go unto the wise.</i> | A scorner does not love one who corrects Him, nor will He go to the wise. |

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| 13 <i>A merry heart maketh a cheerful countenance: but by sorrow of the heart the spirit is broken.</i> | A merry heart makes a cheerful countenance; but by sorrow of the heart the spirit is broken. |
| 14 <i>The heart of him that hath understanding seeketh knowledge: but the mouth of fools feedeth on foolishness.</i> | The heart of Him who has understanding seeks knowledge; but the mouth of fools feeds on foolishness. |
| 15 <i>All the days of the afflicted are evil: but he that is of a merry heart hath a continual feast.</i> | All the days of the afflicted are evil; but He who has a merry heart has a continual feast. |
| 16 <i>Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith.</i> | Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure with trouble. |
| 17 <i>Better is a dinner of herbs where love is, than a stalled ox and hatred therewith.</i> | Better is a dinner of herbs where love is than a fatted ox with hatred. |
| 18 <i>A wrathful man stirreth up strife: but he that is slow to anger appeaseth strife.</i> | A wrathful man stirs up strife; but He who is longsuffering appeases strife. |
| 19 <i>The way of the slothful man is as an hedge of thorns: but the way of the righteous is made plain.</i> | The way of the slothful man is like a hedge of thorns; but the way of the righteous is made plain. |
| 20 <i>A wise son maketh a glad father: but a foolish man despiseth his mother.</i> | A wise son makes a glad father; but a foolish man despises His mother. |
| 21 <i>Folly is joy to him that is destitute of wisdom: but a man of understanding walketh uprightly.</i> | Folly is joy to Him who lacks wisdom; but a man of understanding walks uprightly. |
| 22 <i>Without counsel purposes are disappointed: but in the multitude of counsellors they are established.</i> | Without counsel, purposes are disappointed; but in the multitude of counselors they are established. |
| 23 <i>A man hath joy by the answer of his mouth: and a word spoken in due season, how good is it!</i> | A man has joy by the answer of his mouth, and a word spoken in due season, how good it is! |

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| 24 <i>The way of life is above to the wise, that he may depart from hell beneath.</i> | The way of life leads upward for the wise, that He may depart from hell beneath. |
| 25 <i>The LORD will destroy the house of the proud; but he will establish the border of the widow.</i> | The LORD will destroy the house of the proud; but He will establish the border of the widow. |
| 26 <i>The thoughts of the wicked are an abomination to the LORD: but the words of the pure are pleasant words.</i> | The thoughts of the wicked are an abomination to the LORD; but the words of the pure are pleasant words. |
| 27 <i>He that is greedy of gain troubleth his own house; but he that hateth gifts shall live.</i> | He who is greedy for gain troubles his own house, but He who hates bribes will live. |
| 28 <i>The heart of the righteous studieth to answer: but the mouth of the wicked poureth out evil things.</i> | The heart of the righteous studies how to answer; but the mouth of the wicked pours out evil things. |
| 29 <i>The LORD is far from the wicked: but he heareth the prayer of the righteous.</i> | The LORD is far from the wicked; but he hears the prayer of the righteous. |
| 30 <i>The light of the eyes rejoiceth the heart: and a good report maketh the bones fat.</i> | The light of the eyes rejoices the heart, and a good report makes the bones strong. |
| 31 <i>The ear that heareth the reproof of life abideth among the wise.</i> | The ear that hears the correction of life will remain among the wise. |
| 32 <i>He that refuseth instruction despiseth his own soul: but he that heareth reproof getteth understanding.</i> | He who refuses instruction despises his own soul; but He who hears correction gains understanding. |
| 33 <i>The fear of the LORD is the instruction of wisdom; and before honour is humility.</i> | The fear of the LORD is the instruction of wisdom, and before honor is humility. |

Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

v1 — Prov 25:15; Prov 10:12; Prov 15:18; Prov 29:22; Prov 28:25

v3 — Heb 4:13; Jer 16:17; Jer 23:24; 2 Chr 16:9; Prov 5:21

v4 — Prov 16:24; Prov 12:18; Prov 18:8; Prov 3:18; Mal 4:2

v8 — Prov 15:29; 1 Chr 29:17; Prov 21:27; Isa 1:10-15; Prov 28:9

v11 — Ps 44:21; Ps 139:8; Heb 4:13; Job 26:6; 2 Chr 6:30

v13 — Prov 17:22; John 14:1; Prov 12:25; Prov 18:14; Prov 15:15

v15 — 2 Cor 6:10; Rom 12:12; Prov 15:13; Prov 17:22; Rom 5:11

v16 — Prov 16:8; Ps 37:16; Eccl 5:10-12; 1 Tim 6:6; Prov 28:6

v18 — Prov 15:1; Prov 26:21; Matt 5:9; Prov 29:22; Prov 14:29

v22 — Prov 11:14; Prov 20:18

v23 — Isa 50:4; Prov 25:11-12; Eph 4:29; Prov 12:14; Prov 16:13

v29 — John 9:31; Ps 145:18-19; 1 Pet 3:12; Prov 15:8; Ps 34:15-17

Chapter 16

Contrasting proverbs address the sovereignty of God over human plans, the heart of the king in the LORD's hand, and the pride that goes before destruction. A man's heart plans his way, but the LORD directs his steps, and a wise man's words are gracious and persuasive.

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| 1 <i>The preparations of the heart in man, and the answer of the tongue, is from the LORD.</i> | The preparations of the heart in man and the answer of the tongue are from the LORD. |
| 2 <i>All the ways of a man are clean in his own eyes; but the LORD weigheth the spirits.</i> | All the ways of a man are clean in his own eyes, but the LORD weighs the spirits. |
| 3 <i>Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established.</i> | Commit Your works to the LORD, and Your thoughts will be established. |
| 4 <i>The LORD hath made all things for himself: yea, even the wicked for the day of evil.</i> | The LORD has made all things for Himself, even the wicked for the day of evil. |
| 5 <i>Every one that is proud in heart is an abomination to the LORD: though hand join in hand, he shall not be unpunished.</i> | Everyone who is proud in heart is an abomination to the LORD; though hand join in hand, He will not be unpunished. |
| 6 <i>By mercy and truth iniquity is purged: and by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil.</i> | By mercy and truth iniquity is purged, and by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil. |
| 7 <i>When a man's ways please the LORD, he maketh even his enemies to be at peace with him.</i> | When a man's ways please the LORD, He makes even His enemies to be at peace with Him. |

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| 8 <i>Better is a little with righteousness than great revenues without right.</i> | Better is a little with righteousness than great revenues without justice. |
| 9 <i>A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps.</i> | A man's heart devises his way; but the LORD directs His steps. |
| 10 <i>A divine sentence is in the lips of the king: his mouth transgresseth not in judgment.</i> | A divine sentence is on the lips of the king; his mouth does not transgress in judgment. |
| 11 <i>A just weight and balance are the LORD'S: all the weights of the bag are his work.</i> | A just weight and balance are the LORD's; all the weights of the bag are His work. |
| 12 <i>It is an abomination to kings to commit wickedness: for the throne is established by righteousness.</i> | It is an abomination to kings to commit wickedness, for the throne is established by righteousness. |
| 13 <i>Righteous lips are the delight of kings; and they love him that speaketh right.</i> | Righteous lips are the delight of kings, and they love Him who speaks rightly. |
| 14 <i>The wrath of a king is as messengers of death: but a wise man will pacify it.</i> | The wrath of a king is like messengers of death; but a wise man will pacify it. |
| 15 <i>In the light of the king's countenance is life; and his favour is as a cloud of the latter rain.</i> | In the light of the king's countenance is life, and his favor is like a cloud of the latter rain. |
| 16 <i>How much better is it to get wisdom than gold! and to get understanding rather to be chosen than silver!</i> | How much better it is to get wisdom than gold, and to get understanding rather than silver! |
| 17 <i>The highway of the upright is to depart from evil: he that keepeth his way preserveth his soul.</i> | The highway of the upright is to depart from evil; he who keeps his way preserves his soul. |
| 18 <i>Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.</i> | Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall. |
| 19 <i>Better it is to be of an humble spirit with the lowly, than to divide the spoil with the proud.</i> | It is better to be of a humble spirit with the lowly than to divide the spoil with the proud. |

- 20 *He that handleth a matter wisely shall find good: and whoso trusteth in the LORD, happy is he.* He who handles a matter wisely will find good, and whoever trusts in the LORD, happy is He.
- 21 *The wise in heart shall be called prudent: and the sweetness of the lips increaseth learning.* The wise in heart will be called prudent, and the sweetness of the lips increases learning.
- 22 *Understanding is a wellspring of life unto him that hath it: but the instruction of fools is folly.* Understanding is a wellspring of life to Him who has it; but the instruction of fools is folly.
- 23 *The heart of the wise teacheth his mouth, and addeth learning to his lips.* The heart of the wise teaches His mouth and adds learning to His lips.
- 24 *Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones.* Pleasant words are like a honeycomb, sweet to the soul and health to the bones.
- 25 *There is a way that seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death.* There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the ways of death.
- 26 *He that laboureth laboureth for himself; for his mouth craveth it of him.* He who labors, labors for himself, for his mouth urges Him on.
- 27 *An ungodly man diggeth up evil: and in his lips there is as a burning fire.* An ungodly man digs up evil, and on His lips there is as a burning fire.
- 28 *A froward man soweth strife: and a whisperer separateth chief friends.* A perverse man sows strife, and a whisperer separates close friends.
- 29 *A violent man enticeth his neighbour, and leadeth him into the way that is not good.* A violent man entices His neighbor and leads Him into a way that is not good.
- 30 *He shutteth his eyes to devise froward things: moving his lips he bringeth evil to pass.* He shuts His eyes to devise perverse things; moving His lips, He brings evil to pass.
- 31 *The hoary head is a crown of glory, if it be found in the way of righteousness.* The gray head is a crown of glory, if it is found in the way of righteousness.

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| <p>32 <i>He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city.</i></p> <p>33 <i>The lot is cast into the lap; but the whole disposing thereof is of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>He who is longsuffering is better than the mighty, and He who rules his spirit than he who takes a city.</p> <p>The lot is cast into the lap, but its every decision is from the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Prov 19:21; Prov 16:9; Luke 21:14-15; Phil 2:13; Prov 20:24
v2 — Prov 21:2; 1 Sam 16:7; Luke 16:15; Prov 30:12; Jer 17:10
v3 — Ps 37:4-5; Prov 3:6; Ps 55:22; Phil 4:6; 1 Pet 5:7
v4 — 2 Pet 2:9; Isa 43:21; Rom 9:22; Isa 43:7; 1 Pet 2:8
v5 — Prov 6:16-17; Prov 11:21; Prov 8:13; Rom 2:8-9; Jas 4:6
v6 — Prov 14:16; 2 Cor 7:1; Job 28:28; Dan 4:27; Prov 14:27
v7 — Rom 8:31; 1 John 3:22; 2 Chr 17:10; Col 1:10; Jer 15:11
v8 — Prov 15:16; Ps 37:16; 1 Tim 6:6-9; Jer 17:11; Prov 21:6-7
v9 — Prov 19:21; Ps 37:23; Prov 16:1; Prov 20:24; Jer 10:23
v18 — Prov 11:2; Isa 2:11-12; Prov 18:12; Obad 1:3-4; Prov 29:23
v24 — Prov 12:18; Prov 24:13-14; Prov 25:11-12; Prov 4:22; Prov 23:16
v32 — Jas 1:19; Prov 15:18; Prov 25:28; Prov 14:29; Prov 19:11

Chapter 17

Contrasting proverbs address the value of peace over conflict, the testing of hearts by the LORD as a refiner tests silver, and the loyalty of a true friend who loves at all times. The chapter warns against mocking the poor, rejoicing at calamity, and provoking strife.

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| <p>1 <i>Better is a dry morsel, and quietness therewith, than an house full of sacrifices with strife.</i></p> <p>2 <i>A wise servant shall have rule over a son that causeth shame, and shall have part of the inheritance among the brethren.</i></p> <p>3 <i>The fining pot is for silver, and the furnace for gold: but the LORD trieth the hearts.</i></p> | <p>Better is a dry morsel with quietness than a house full of sacrifices with strife.</p> <p>A wise servant will rule over a son who causes shame, and will share the inheritance among the brethren.</p> <p>The refining pot is for silver and the furnace for gold; but the LORD tests the hearts.</p> |
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| 4 <i>A wicked doer giveth heed to false lips; and a liar giveth ear to a naughty tongue.</i> | A wicked doer gives heed to false lips, and a liar gives ear to a destructive tongue. |
| 5 <i>Whoso mocketh the poor reproacheth his Maker: and he that is glad at calamities shall not be unpunished.</i> | Whoever mocks the poor reproaches his Maker, and he who is glad at calamities will not be unpunished. |
| 6 <i>Children's children are the crown of old men; and the glory of children are their fathers.</i> | Children's children are the crown of old men, and the glory of children is their fathers. |
| 7 <i>Excellent speech becometh not a fool: much less do lying lips a prince.</i> | Excellent speech is not fitting for a fool, much less are lying lips for a prince. |
| 8 <i>A gift is as a precious stone in the eyes of him that hath it: whithersoever it turneth, it prospereth.</i> | A gift is like a precious stone in the eyes of Him who has it; wherever it turns, it prospers. |
| 9 <i>He that covereth a transgression seeketh love; and he that repeateth a matter separateth very friends.</i> | He who covers a transgression seeks love, but he who repeats a matter separates close friends. |
| 10 <i>A reproof entereth more into a wise man than an hundred stripes into a fool.</i> | A rebuke enters more deeply into a wise man than a hundred stripes into a fool. |
| 11 <i>An evil man seeketh only rebellion: therefore a cruel messenger shall be sent against him.</i> | An evil man seeks only rebellion; therefore a cruel messenger will be sent against Him. |
| 12 <i>Let a bear robbed of her whelps meet a man, rather than a fool in his folly.</i> | Let a bear robbed of her cubs meet a man, rather than a fool in his folly. |
| 13 <i>Whoso rewardeth evil for good, evil shall not depart from his house.</i> | Whoever rewards evil for good, evil will not depart from His house. |
| 14 <i>The beginning of strife is as when one letteth out water: therefore leave off contention, before it be meddled with.</i> | The beginning of strife is like releasing water; therefore stop contention before it breaks out. |
| 15 <i>He that justifieth the wicked, and he that condemneth the just, even they both are abomination to the LORD.</i> | He who justifies the wicked, and he who condemns the just, even both of them are an abomination to the LORD. |

- 16 *Wherefore is there a price in the hand of a fool to get wisdom, seeing he hath no heart to it?* Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to get wisdom, when He has no heart for it?
- 17 *A friend loveth at all times, and a brother is born for a time of adversity.* A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for a time of adversity.
- 18 *A man void of understanding striketh hands, and becometh surety in the presence of his friend.* A man without understanding strikes hands in pledge and becomes surety in the presence of His friend.
- 19 *He loveth transgression that loveth strife: and he that exalteth his gate seeketh destruction.* He who loves transgression loves strife, and he who exalts his gate seeks destruction.
- 20 *He that hath a froward heart findeth no good: and he that hath a perverse tongue falleth into mischief.* He who has a perverse heart finds no good, and he who has a perverse tongue falls into mischief.
- 21 *He that begetteth a fool doeth it to his sorrow: and the father of a fool hath no joy.* He who fathers a fool does so to his sorrow, and the father of a fool has no joy.
- 22 *A merry heart doeth good like a medicine: but a broken spirit drieth the bones.* A merry heart does good like a medicine; but a broken spirit dries the bones.
- 23 *A wicked man taketh a gift out of the bosom to pervert the ways of judgment.* A wicked man takes a gift out of the bosom to pervert the ways of judgment.
- 24 *Wisdom is before him that hath understanding; but the eyes of a fool are in the ends of the earth.* Wisdom is before Him who has understanding, but the eyes of a fool are on the ends of the earth.
- 25 *A foolish son is a grief to his father, and bitterness to her that bare him.* A foolish son is a grief to His father, and bitterness to her who bore Him.
- 26 *Also to punish the just is not good, nor to strike princes for equity.* Also, to punish the just is not good, nor to strike princes for fairness.
- 27 *He that hath knowledge spareth his words: and a man of understanding is of an excellent spirit.* He who has knowledge spares his words, and a man of understanding is of an excellent spirit.

28	<i>Even a fool, when he holdeth his peace, is counted wise: and he that shutteth his lips is esteemed a man of understanding.</i>	Even a fool, when He holds His peace, is counted wise, and He who shuts his lips is esteemed a man of understanding.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 15:17; Ps 37:16; Prov 21:19; Prov 21:9
- v3 — Isa 48:10; Jer 17:10; Ps 26:2; Prov 27:21; 1 Chr 29:17
- v5 — Prov 14:31; Job 31:29; Obad 1:11-13; 1 John 3:17; Prov 16:5
- v6 — Ps 127:3-5; Prov 16:31; Prov 13:22; Ps 128:3-6
- v9 — Prov 10:12; 1 Pet 4:8; Prov 16:28; Ps 32:1
- v13 — Ps 109:4-13; Rom 12:17; Ps 55:12-15; 1 Pet 3:9; Ps 38:20
- v15 — Ex 23:7; Isa 5:23; Prov 18:5; Prov 24:23-24; Amos 6:12
- v17 — Prov 18:24; John 15:13-14; 1 Sam 20:17; 1 Sam 18:3; Prov 19:7
- v18 — Prov 11:15; Prov 6:1-5; Prov 22:26-27
- v22 — Prov 15:13; Prov 12:25; Prov 18:14; 2 Cor 7:10; Eccl 9:7-9
- v27 — Jas 3:18; Jas 1:19; Prov 10:19; Prov 14:29; Prov 15:28
- v28 — Job 13:5; Prov 15:2; Eccl 10:14; Eccl 5:3; Eccl 10:3

Chapter 18

Contrasting proverbs address the danger of isolation, the fool who delights only in expressing his own opinion, the power of the tongue (death and life are in its power), and the name of the LORD as a strong tower where the righteous run and are safe. A man who finds a wife finds a good thing and obtains favor of the LORD.

1	<i>Through desire a man, having separated himself, seeketh and intermeddleth with all wisdom.</i>	Through desire a man who has separated himself seeks and quarrels against all sound wisdom.
2	<i>A fool hath no delight in understanding, but that his heart may discover itself.</i>	A fool has no delight in understanding, but only in revealing His own heart.
3	<i>When the wicked cometh, then cometh also contempt, and with ignominy reproach.</i>	When the wicked comes, contempt also comes, and with dishonor comes reproach.

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| 4 <i>The words of a man's mouth are as deep waters, and the wellspring of wisdom as a flowing brook.</i> | The words of a man's mouth are like deep waters, and the wellspring of wisdom like a flowing brook. |
| 5 <i>It is not good to accept the person of the wicked, to overthrow the righteous in judgment.</i> | It is not good to show favor to the wicked, to overthrow the righteous in judgment. |
| 6 <i>A fool's lips enter into contention, and his mouth calleth for strokes.</i> | A fool's lips enter into contention, and his mouth calls for blows. |
| 7 <i>A fool's mouth is his destruction, and his lips are the snare of his soul.</i> | A fool's mouth is his destruction, and his lips are the snare of his soul. |
| 8 <i>The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly.</i> | The words of a talebearer are like wounds, and they go down to the innermost parts of the belly. |
| 9 <i>He also that is slothful in his work is brother to him that is a great waster.</i> | He who is slothful in his work is brother to him who is a great waster. |
| 10 <i>The name of the LORD is a strong tower: the righteous runneth into it, and is safe.</i> | The name of the LORD is a strong tower; the righteous runs into it and is safe. |
| 11 <i>The rich man's wealth is his strong city, and as an high wall in his own conceit.</i> | The rich man's wealth is his strong city, and like a high wall in his own imagination. |
| 12 <i>Before destruction the heart of man is haughty, and before honour is humility.</i> | Before destruction the heart of man is haughty, and before honor is humility. |
| 13 <i>He that answereth a matter before he heareth it, it is folly and shame unto him.</i> | He who answers a matter before he hears it, it is folly and shame to him. |
| 14 <i>The spirit of a man will sustain his infirmity; but a wounded spirit who can bear?</i> | The spirit of a man will sustain his infirmity, but a wounded spirit who can bear? |
| 15 <i>The heart of the prudent getteth knowledge; and the ear of the wise seeketh knowledge.</i> | The heart of the prudent gains knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks knowledge. |

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| 16 <i>A man's gift maketh room for him, and bringeth him before great men.</i> | A man's gift makes room for him and brings him before great men. |
| 17 <i>He that is first in his own cause seemeth just; but his neighbour cometh and searcheth him.</i> | He who is first in his own cause seems just, but his neighbor comes and examines him. |
| 18 <i>The lot causeth contentions to cease, and parteth between the mighty.</i> | The lot causes contentions to cease and parts between the mighty. |
| 19 <i>A brother offended is harder to be won than a strong city: and their contentions are like the bars of a castle.</i> | A brother offended is harder to be won than a strong city, and their contentions are like the bars of a castle. |
| 20 <i>A man's belly shall be satisfied with the fruit of his mouth; and with the increase of his lips shall he be filled.</i> | A man's belly will be satisfied with the fruit of his mouth, and with the increase of his lips he will be filled. |
| 21 <i>Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof.</i> | Death and life are in the power of the tongue, and those who love it will eat its fruit. |
| 22 <i>Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD.</i> | Whoever finds a wife finds a good thing and obtains favor from the LORD. |
| 23 <i>The poor useth intreaties; but the rich answereth roughly.</i> | The poor uses entreaties, but the rich answers roughly. |
| 24 <i>A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly: and there is a friend that sticketh closer than a brother.</i> | A man who has friends must show himself friendly, and there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eph 5:15-17; Prov 20:3; Prov 2:1-6; Prov 24:21; Jer 15:17
v2 — Prov 1:7; Prov 12:23; Ps 1:1-2; Prov 17:16; Prov 13:16
v4 — Prov 20:5; Prov 10:11; Col 4:6; John 4:14; Prov 13:14
v7 — Prov 13:3; Prov 12:13; Prov 10:14; Ps 64:8; Ps 140:9
v9 — Prov 10:4; Heb 6:12; Prov 24:30-34; Prov 23:20-21; Rom 12:11
v10 — 2 Sam 22:3; Ps 91:2; Isa 26:4; Ps 144:2; Ps 61:3-4
v12 — Prov 15:33; 1 Pet 5:5; Prov 16:18; Ezek 28:2; Prov 11:2

v14 — Prov 15:13; Prov 17:22; 2 Cor 12:9-10; 1 Pet 1:6; Ps 147:3

v15 — Jas 1:5; Prov 15:14; Luke 10:39; Prov 1:5; 1 Kgs 3:9

v21 — Eph 4:29; Matt 12:35-37; Col 4:6; Prov 10:19-21; Jas 3:6-9

v22 — Prov 19:14; Prov 31:10-31; Prov 12:4; Eccl 9:9; 1 Cor 7:2

v24 — Prov 17:17; John 15:13-15; Prov 27:9; 2 Sam 1:26; 1 Sam 19:4-5

Chapter 19

Contrasting proverbs address the integrity of the poor versus the perverseness of the rich fool, the value of patience and discretion, and the fear of the LORD that leads to life. The chapter warns against laziness, false witnesses, and neglecting to discipline a child while there is hope.

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| <p>1 <i>Better is the poor that walketh in his integrity, than he that is perverse in his lips, and is a fool.</i></p> | <p>Better is the poor who walks in His integrity than He who is perverse in his lips and is a fool.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Also, that the soul be without knowledge, it is not good; and he that hasteth with his feet sinneth.</i></p> | <p>Also, that the soul be without knowledge is not good, and He who hastens with his feet sins.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The foolishness of man perverteth his way: and his heart fretteth against the LORD.</i></p> | <p>The foolishness of man perverts His way, and His heart frets against the LORD.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Wealth maketh many friends; but the poor is separated from his neighbour.</i></p> | <p>Wealth makes many friends, but the poor is separated from His neighbor.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>A false witness shall not be unpunished, and he that speaketh lies shall not escape.</i></p> | <p>A false witness will not be unpunished, and He who speaks lies will not escape.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Many will intreat the favour of the prince: and every man is a friend to him that giveth gifts.</i></p> | <p>Many will entreat the favor of the prince, and every man is a friend to him who gives gifts.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>All the brethren of the poor do hate him: how much more do his friends go far from him? he pursueth them with words, yet they are wanting to him.</i></p> | <p>All the brethren of the poor hate him; how much more do his friends go far from him! He pursues them with words, yet they are gone.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>He that getteth wisdom loveth his own soul: he that keepeth understanding shall find good.</i></p> | <p>He who gets wisdom loves his own soul; he who keeps understanding will find good.</p> |

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| 9 | <i>A false witness shall not be unpunished, and he that speaketh lies shall perish.</i> | A false witness will not be unpunished, and he who speaks lies will perish. |
| 10 | <i>Delight is not seemly for a fool; much less for a servant to have rule over princes.</i> | Delight is not fitting for a fool, much less for a servant to rule over princes. |
| 11 | <i>The discretion of a man deferreth his anger; and it is his glory to pass over a transgression.</i> | The discretion of a man defers his anger, and it is his glory to pass over a transgression. |
| 12 | <i>The king's wrath is as the roaring of a lion; but his favour is as dew upon the grass.</i> | The king's wrath is like the roaring of a lion, but his favor is like dew on the grass. |
| 13 | <i>A foolish son is the calamity of his father: and the contentions of a wife are a continual dropping.</i> | A foolish son is the calamity of his father, and the contentions of a wife are a continual dripping. |
| 14 | <i>House and riches are the inheritance of fathers: and a prudent wife is from the LORD.</i> | House and riches are the inheritance of fathers, but a prudent wife is from the LORD. |
| 15 | <i>Slothfulness casteth into a deep sleep; and an idle soul shall suffer hunger.</i> | Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep, and an idle soul will suffer hunger. |
| 16 | <i>He that keepeth the commandment keepeth his own soul; but he that despiseth his ways shall die.</i> | He who keeps the commandment keeps his own soul, but He who despises his ways will die. |
| 17 | <i>He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the LORD; and that which he hath given will he pay him again.</i> | He who has pity on the poor lends to the LORD, and what He has given He will repay Him. |
| 18 | <i>Chasten thy son while there is hope, and let not thy soul spare for his crying.</i> | Chasten Your son while there is hope, and do not let Your soul spare Him because of His crying. |
| 19 | <i>A man of great wrath shall suffer punishment: for if thou deliver him, yet thou must do it again.</i> | A man of great wrath will suffer punishment, for if You deliver Him, You must do it again. |

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| 20 <i>Hear counsel, and receive instruction, that thou mayest be wise in thy latter end.</i> | Hear counsel and receive instruction, that You may be wise in Your latter end. |
| 21 <i>There are many devices in a man's heart; nevertheless the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand.</i> | There are many devices in a man's heart, but the counsel of the LORD will stand. |
| 22 <i>The desire of a man is his kindness: and a poor man is better than a liar.</i> | The desire of a man is his kindness, and a poor man is better than a liar. |
| 23 <i>The fear of the LORD tendeth to life: and he that hath it shall abide satisfied; he shall not be visited with evil.</i> | The fear of the LORD leads to life, and He who has it will abide satisfied; he will not be visited with evil. |
| 24 <i>A slothful man hideth his hand in his bosom, and will not so much as bring it to his mouth again.</i> | A slothful man hides His hand in His bosom and will not even bring it to His mouth again. |
| 25 <i>Smite a scorner, and the simple will beware: and reprove one that hath understanding, and he will understand knowledge.</i> | Strike a scorner, and the simple will beware; correct one who has understanding, and He will gain knowledge. |
| 26 <i>He that wasteth his father, and chaseth away his mother, is a son that causeth shame, and bringeth reproach.</i> | He who wastes his father and drives away his mother is a son who causes shame and brings reproach. |
| 27 <i>Cease, my son, to hear the instruction that causeth to err from the words of knowledge.</i> | Cease, my son, to hear the instruction that causes You to stray from the words of knowledge. |
| 28 <i>An ungodly witness scorneth judgment: and the mouth of the wicked devoureth iniquity.</i> | An ungodly witness scorns judgment, and the mouth of the wicked devours iniquity. |
| 29 <i>Judgments are prepared for scorners, and stripes for the back of fools.</i> | Judgments are prepared for scorners, and stripes for the back of fools. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Prov 21:5; Prov 29:20; Phil 1:9; Isa 28:16; Eccl 7:9
 v6 — Prov 29:26; Prov 18:16; Prov 17:8; Gen 42:6; Rom 6:23
 v8 — Prov 16:20; Prov 8:35-36; Prov 4:6; Prov 3:18; 1 Pet 3:10
 v11 — Prov 16:32; Prov 14:29; Jas 1:19; Col 3:12-13; Prov 15:18
 v14 — Prov 18:22; Prov 31:10-31; Prov 13:22; Prov 3:6; Jas 1:17
 v15 — Prov 23:21; Prov 20:13; 2 Thess 3:10; Prov 6:9-10; Rom 13:11-12
 v16 — Luke 10:28; Prov 13:13; 1 John 5:3; Luke 11:28; Prov 16:17
 v17 — Prov 28:27; Heb 6:10; Luke 6:38; 2 Cor 9:6-8; Matt 25:40
 v18 — Prov 13:24; Prov 29:15; Prov 23:13-14; Prov 22:15; Heb 12:7-10
 v20 — Prov 12:15; Prov 8:34-35; Prov 2:1-9; Prov 1:8; Prov 4:1
 v21 — Prov 16:9; Isa 14:24; Prov 16:1; Ps 33:10-11; Isa 46:10
 v23 — Matt 5:6; Prov 14:26-27; Prov 12:21; Isa 58:10-11; 1 Tim 4:8

Chapter 20

Contrasting proverbs address the deceptiveness of wine, the honor of avoiding strife, the varied weights and measures that are an abomination to the LORD, and the fact that a man's steps are directed by the LORD though he does not understand his own way. The spirit of man is the lamp of the LORD, searching his inmost being.

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| 1 | <i>Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise.</i> | Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging, and whoever is deceived by them is not wise. |
| 2 | <i>The fear of a king is as the roaring of a lion: whoso provoketh him to anger sinneth against his own soul.</i> | The fear of a king is like the roaring of a lion; whoever provokes him to anger sins against his own soul. |
| 3 | <i>It is an honour for a man to cease from strife: but every fool will be meddling.</i> | It is an honor for a man to cease from strife; but every fool will be meddling. |
| 4 | <i>The sluggard will not plow by reason of the cold; therefore shall he beg in harvest, and have nothing.</i> | The sluggard will not plow because of the cold; therefore He will beg in harvest and have nothing. |
| 5 | <i>Counsel in the heart of man is like deep water; but a man of understanding will draw it out.</i> | Counsel in the heart of man is like deep water, but a man of understanding will draw it out. |
| 6 | <i>Most men will proclaim every one his own goodness: but a faithful man who can find?</i> | Most men will proclaim each His own goodness; but a faithful man who can find? |

- 7 *The just man walketh in his integrity: his children are blessed after him.* The just man walks in His integrity; His children are blessed after Him.
- 8 *A king that sitteth in the throne of judgment scattereth away all evil with his eyes.* A king who sits on the throne of judgment scatters away all evil with His eyes.
- 9 *Who can say, I have made my heart clean, I am pure from my sin?* Who can say, "I have made my heart clean; I am pure from my sin"?
- 10 *Divers weights, and divers measures, both of them are alike abomination to the LORD.* Different weights and different measures, both alike are an abomination to the LORD.
- 11 *Even a child is known by his doings, whether his work be pure, and whether it be right.* Even a child is known by His doings, whether His work is pure and whether it is right.
- 12 *The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, the LORD hath made even both of them.* The hearing ear and the seeing eye, the LORD has made them both.
- 13 *Love not sleep, lest thou come to poverty; open thine eyes, and thou shalt be satisfied with bread.* Do not love sleep, lest You come to poverty; open Your eyes, and You will be satisfied with bread.
- 14 *It is naught, it is naught, saith the buyer: but when he is gone his way, then he boasteth.* "It is worthless, it is worthless," says the buyer; but when He is gone on His way, then He boasts.
- 15 *There is gold, and a multitude of rubies: but the lips of knowledge are a precious jewel.* There is gold and a multitude of rubies; but the lips of knowledge are a precious jewel.
- 16 *Take his garment that is surety for a stranger: and take a pledge of him for a strange woman.* Take the garment of Him who is surety for a stranger, and take a pledge from Him for a strange woman.
- 17 *Bread of deceit is sweet to a man; but afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel.* Bread of deceit is sweet to a man, but afterward his mouth will be filled with gravel.
- 18 *Every purpose is established by counsel: and with good advice make war.* Every purpose is established by counsel, and with good advice wage war.

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| 19 <i>He that goeth about as a talebearer revealeth secrets; therefore meddle not with him that flattereth with his lips.</i> | He who goes about as a talebearer reveals secrets; therefore do not associate with Him who flatters with His lips. |
| 20 <i>Whoso curseth his father or his mother, his lamp shall be put out in obscure darkness.</i> | Whoever curses his father or his mother, his lamp will be put out in deep darkness. |
| 21 <i>An inheritance may be gotten hastily at the beginning; but the end thereof shall not be blessed.</i> | An inheritance may be gained hastily at the beginning, but its end will not be blessed. |
| 22 <i>Say not thou, I will recompense evil; but wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee.</i> | Do not say, "I will repay evil"; wait on the LORD, and He will save You. |
| 23 <i>Divers weights are an abomination unto the LORD; and a false balance is not good.</i> | Different weights are an abomination to the LORD, and a false balance is not good. |
| 24 <i>Man's goings are of the LORD; how can a man then understand his own way?</i> | A man's steps are of the LORD; how then can a man understand his own way? |
| 25 <i>It is a snare to the man who devoureth that which is holy, and after vows to make enquiry.</i> | It is a snare for a man to vow rashly something holy, and afterward to consider His vows. |
| 26 <i>A wise king scattereth the wicked, and bringeth the wheel over them.</i> | A wise king scatters the wicked and brings the wheel over them. |
| 27 <i>The spirit of man is the candle of the LORD, searching all the inward parts of the belly.</i> | The spirit of man is the candle of the LORD, searching all the inward parts of the belly. |
| 28 <i>Mercy and truth preserve the king: and his throne is upholden by mercy.</i> | Mercy and truth preserve the king, and his throne is upheld by mercy. |
| 29 <i>The glory of young men is their strength: and the beauty of old men is the grey head.</i> | The glory of young men is their strength, and the beauty of old men is the grey head. |

30	<i>The blueness of a wound cleanseth away evil: so do stripes the inward parts of the belly.</i>	The bruises of a wound cleanse away evil, and so do stripes the inward parts of the belly.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eph 5:18; Hos 4:11; Isa 28:7; 1 Cor 6:10; Prov 31:4
- v3 — Prov 16:32; Prov 17:14; Prov 19:11; Prov 18:6; Eph 4:32-5:1
- v4 — Prov 10:4; Prov 19:15; Prov 13:4; Matt 25:24-28; Matt 25:3-10
- v5 — 1 Cor 2:11; Prov 18:4; Ps 64:6
- v7 — Ps 112:2; Ps 37:26; Jer 32:39; 2 Cor 1:12; Acts 2:39
- v12 — Matt 13:13-16; Ps 94:9; Ps 119:18; Ex 4:11; Eph 1:17-18
- v13 — Prov 19:15; Rom 12:11; Rom 13:11; Prov 12:11; Prov 10:4
- v20 — Ex 21:17; Prov 30:11; Prov 30:17; Matt 15:4; Deut 27:16
- v22 — Rom 12:17-19; 1 Thess 5:15; Prov 24:29; Prov 17:13; 1 Pet 3:9
- v24 — Prov 16:9; Jer 10:23; Ps 25:12; Ps 37:23; Ps 25:4
- v27 — 1 Cor 2:11; Heb 4:12-13; Job 32:8; 1 John 3:19-21; Gen 2:7
- v29 — 1 John 2:14; Prov 16:31; Lev 19:32; Jer 9:23-24

Chapter 21

Contrasting proverbs address the king's heart in the LORD's hand, the sacrifice of the wicked as an abomination, and the futility of human plans against the counsel of the LORD. The chapter warns that whoever shuts his ears to the cry of the poor will himself cry and not be heard.

1	<i>The king's heart is in the hand of the LORD, as the rivers of water: he turneth it whithersoever he will.</i>	The king's heart is in the hand of the LORD, like the rivers of water; He turns it wherever He wills.
2	<i>Every way of a man is right in his own eyes: but the LORD pondereth the hearts.</i>	Every way of a man is right in his own eyes; but the LORD ponders the hearts.
3	<i>To do justice and judgment is more acceptable to the LORD than sacrifice.</i>	To do justice and judgment is more acceptable to the LORD than sacrifice.
4	<i>An high look, and a proud heart, and the plowing of the wicked, is sin.</i>	A high look, a proud heart, and the plowing of the wicked are sin.

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| 5 <i>The thoughts of the diligent tend only to plenteousness; but of every one that is hasty only to want.</i> | The thoughts of the diligent tend only to plenty, but of everyone who is hasty only to want. |
| 6 <i>The getting of treasures by a lying tongue is a vanity tossed to and fro of them that seek death.</i> | Gaining treasures by a lying tongue is a vanity tossed to and fro by those who seek death. |
| 7 <i>The robbery of the wicked shall destroy them; because they refuse to do judgment.</i> | The robbery of the wicked will destroy them, because they refuse to do justice. |
| 8 <i>The way of man is froward and strange: but as for the pure, his work is right.</i> | The way of man is perverse and strange; but as for the pure, his work is right. |
| 9 <i>It is better to dwell in a corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman in a wide house.</i> | It is better to live in a corner of the housetop than with a contentious woman in a wide house. |
| 10 <i>The soul of the wicked desireth evil: his neighbour findeth no favour in his eyes.</i> | The soul of the wicked desires evil; his neighbor finds no favor in his eyes. |
| 11 <i>When the scorner is punished, the simple is made wise: and when the wise is instructed, he receiveth knowledge.</i> | When the scorner is punished, the simple is made wise, and when the wise is instructed, he receives knowledge. |
| 12 <i>The righteous man wisely considereth the house of the wicked: but God overthroweth the wicked for their wickedness.</i> | The righteous man wisely considers the house of the wicked; but God overthrows the wicked for their wickedness. |
| 13 <i>Whoso stoppeth his ears at the cry of the poor, he also shall cry himself, but shall not be heard.</i> | Whoever stops his ears at the cry of the poor will also cry himself, but will not be heard. |
| 14 <i>A gift in secret pacifieth anger: and a reward in the bosom strong wrath.</i> | A gift in secret pacifies anger, and a reward in the bosom, strong wrath. |
| 15 <i>It is joy to the just to do judgment: but destruction shall be to the workers of iniquity.</i> | It is joy to the just to do justice; but destruction will come to the workers of iniquity. |

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| 16 <i>The man that wandereth out of the way of understanding shall remain in the congregation of the dead.</i> | The man who wanders out of the way of understanding will remain in the congregation of the dead. |
| 17 <i>He that loveth pleasure shall be a poor man: he that loveth wine and oil shall not be rich.</i> | He who loves pleasure will be a poor man; he who loves wine and oil will not be rich. |
| 18 <i>The wicked shall be a ransom for the righteous, and the transgressor for the upright.</i> | The wicked will be a ransom for the righteous, and the transgressor for the upright. |
| 19 <i>It is better to dwell in the wilderness, than with a contentious and an angry woman.</i> | It is better to live in the wilderness than with a contentious and angry woman. |
| 20 <i>There is treasure to be desired and oil in the dwelling of the wise; but a foolish man spendeth it up.</i> | There is treasure to be desired and oil in the dwelling of the wise, but a foolish man squanders it. |
| 21 <i>He that followeth after righteousness and mercy findeth life, righteousness, and honour.</i> | He who follows after righteousness and mercy finds life, righteousness, and honor. |
| 22 <i>A wise man scaleth the city of the mighty, and casteth down the strength of the confidence thereof.</i> | A wise man scales the city of the mighty and casts down the strength of its confidence. |
| 23 <i>Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles.</i> | Whoever keeps his mouth and his tongue keeps his soul from troubles. |
| 24 <i>Proud and haughty scorner is his name, who dealeth in proud wrath.</i> | Proud and haughty scorner is his name, who deals in proud wrath. |
| 25 <i>The desire of the slothful killeth him; for his hands refuse to labour.</i> | The desire of the slothful kills him, for his hands refuse to labor. |
| 26 <i>He coveteth greedily all the day long: but the righteous giveth and spareth not.</i> | He covets greedily all the day long; but the righteous gives and does not spare. |
| 27 <i>The sacrifice of the wicked is abomination: how much more, when he bringeth it with a wicked mind?</i> | The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination; how much more when he brings it with a wicked mind! |

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| 28 | <i>A false witness shall perish: but the man that heareth speaketh constantly.</i> | A false witness will perish; but the man who hears speaks steadily. |
| 29 | <i>A wicked man hardeneth his face: but as for the upright, he directeth his way.</i> | A wicked man hardens his face; but as for the upright, he establishes his way. |
| 30 | <i>There is no wisdom nor understanding nor counsel against the LORD.</i> | There is no wisdom, nor understanding, nor counsel against the LORD. |
| 31 | <i>The horse is prepared against the day of battle: but safety is of the LORD.</i> | The horse is prepared for the day of battle; but safety is of the LORD. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 16:9; Ezra 6:22; Prov 20:24; Acts 7:10; Prov 16:1
v2 — Prov 16:2; Prov 16:25; Luke 16:15; Jer 17:10; 1 Sam 16:7
v3 — 1 Sam 15:22; Hos 6:6; Prov 15:8; Mic 6:6-8; Mark 12:33
v5 — Prov 10:4; Prov 13:4; 1 Thess 4:11-12; Eph 4:28; Prov 27:23-27
v9 — Prov 21:19; Prov 19:13; Prov 27:15-16; Prov 25:24; Prov 12:4
v17 — Prov 23:21; 1 Tim 5:6; 2 Tim 3:4; Prov 5:10-11; Prov 21:20
v18 — Prov 11:8; Isa 43:3-4; Isa 53:4-5; 1 Pet 3:18; Isa 55:8-9
v20 — Matt 25:3-4; Ps 112:3; Eccl 5:19; Prov 15:6; Eccl 7:11
v21 — Matt 5:6; 1 Cor 15:58; Prov 22:4; Heb 12:14; Prov 15:9
v23 — Prov 13:3; Prov 18:21; Prov 17:27-28; Jas 1:26; Prov 12:13
v30 — Prov 19:21; Acts 5:39; Jer 9:23; Isa 14:27; 1 Cor 3:19-20
v31 — Ps 20:7; Isa 31:1; Ps 33:17-18; Ps 147:10; Ps 68:20

Chapter 22

Contrasting proverbs address the value of a good name above riches, the training of a child in the way he should go, the snares of the strange woman, and the duty not to rob the poor or crush the afflicted. The chapter transitions into the sayings of the wise, beginning a section of longer counsels.

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| 1 | <i>A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.</i> | A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favor rather than silver and gold. |
| 2 | <i>The rich and poor meet together: the LORD is the maker of them all.</i> | The rich and the poor meet together; the LORD is the Maker of them all. |

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| 3 <i>A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself: but the simple pass on, and are punished.</i> | A prudent man foresees the evil and hides Himself; but the simple pass on and are punished. |
| 4 <i>By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life.</i> | By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, honor, and life. |
| 5 <i>Thorns and snares are in the way of the froward: he that doth keep his soul shall be far from them.</i> | Thorns and snares are in the way of the perverse; He who keeps his soul will be far from them. |
| 6 <i>Train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.</i> | Train up a child in the way He should go, and when He is old, He will not depart from it. |
| 7 <i>The rich ruleth over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender.</i> | The rich rules over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender. |
| 8 <i>He that soweth iniquity shall reap vanity: and the rod of his anger shall fail.</i> | He who sows iniquity will reap vanity, and the rod of His anger will fail. |
| 9 <i>He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; for he giveth of his bread to the poor.</i> | He who has a bountiful eye will be blessed, for he gives of His bread to the poor. |
| 10 <i>Cast out the scorner, and contention shall go out; yea, strife and reproach shall cease.</i> | Cast out the scorner, and contention will go out; strife and reproach will cease. |
| 11 <i>He that loveth pureness of heart, for the grace of his lips the king shall be his friend.</i> | He who loves pureness of heart, for the grace of his lips the king will be his friend. |
| 12 <i>The eyes of the LORD preserve knowledge, and he overthroweth the words of the transgressor.</i> | The eyes of the LORD preserve knowledge, and He overthrows the words of the transgressor. |
| 13 <i>The slothful man saith, There is a lion without, I shall be slain in the streets.</i> | The slothful man says, "There is a lion outside; I will be slain in the streets!" |
| 14 <i>The mouth of strange women is a deep pit: he that is abhorred of the LORD shall fall therein.</i> | The mouth of strange women is a deep pit; He who is abhorred by the LORD will fall into it. |

- 15 *Foolishness is bound in the heart of a child; but the rod of correction shall drive it far from him.* Foolishness is bound in the heart of a child, but the rod of correction will drive it far from Him.
- 16 *He that oppresseth the poor to increase his riches, and he that giveth to the rich, shall surely come to want.* He who oppresses the poor to increase his riches, and He who gives to the rich, will surely come to poverty.
- 17 *Bow down thine ear, and hear the words of the wise, and apply thine heart unto my knowledge.* Bow down Your ear and hear the words of the wise, and apply Your heart to my knowledge.
- 18 *For it is a pleasant thing if thou keep them within thee; they shall withal be fitted in thy lips.* For it is a pleasant thing if You keep them within You; they will be ready on Your lips.
- 19 *That thy trust may be in the LORD, I have made known to thee this day, even to thee.* So that Your trust may be in the LORD, I have made known to You this day, even to You.
- 20 *Have not I written to thee excellent things in counsels and knowledge,* Have I not written to You excellent things in counsels and knowledge,
- 21 *That I might make thee know the certainty of the words of truth; that thou mightest answer the words of truth to them that send unto thee?* so that I might make You know the certainty of the words of truth, that You might answer the words of truth to those who send to You?
- 22 *Rob not the poor, because he is poor: neither oppress the afflicted in the gate:* Do not rob the poor because He is poor, nor oppress the afflicted in the gate,
- 23 *For the LORD will plead their cause, and spoil the soul of those that spoiled them.* for the LORD will plead their cause, and plunder the soul of those who plundered them.
- 24 *Make no friendship with an angry man; and with a furious man thou shalt not go:* Make no friendship with an angry man, and with a furious man do not go,
- 25 *Lest thou learn his ways, and get a snare to thy soul.* lest You learn His ways and bring a snare to Your soul.

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| 26 | <i>Be not thou one of them that strike hands, or of them that are sureties for debts.</i> | Do not be one of those who strike hands in pledge, or those who are sureties for debts. |
| 27 | <i>If thou hast nothing to pay, why should he take away thy bed from under thee?</i> | If You have nothing to pay, why should He take away Your bed from under You? |
| 28 | <i>Remove not the ancient landmark, which thy fathers have set.</i> | Do not remove the ancient landmark which Your fathers have set. |
| 29 | <i>Seest thou a man diligent in his business? he shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before mean men.</i> | Do You see a man diligent in his business? He will stand before kings; He will not stand before lowly men. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eccl 7:1; Luke 10:20
v2 — Job 31:15; 1 Sam 2:7; Prov 14:31; Prov 29:13; Job 34:19
v3 — Prov 27:12; Prov 14:16; Prov 29:1; 1 Thess 5:2-6; Heb 11:7
v4 — Matt 6:33; Jas 4:10; Ps 34:9-10; Prov 21:21; Ps 112:1-3
v6 — Eph 6:4; Deut 6:7; 2 Tim 3:15; Gen 18:19; Deut 4:9
v7 — 2 Kgs 4:1; Matt 18:25; Prov 22:16; Prov 14:31; Prov 18:23
v8 — Gal 6:7-8; Job 4:8; Isa 30:31; Hos 10:13; Ps 125:3
v9 — Prov 19:17; Heb 6:10; 1 Tim 6:18-19; Acts 20:35; 1 Pet 4:9
v15 — Prov 13:24; Prov 29:15; Prov 19:18; Prov 23:13-14; Heb 12:10-11
v23 — Ps 12:5; Ps 140:12; Jer 51:36; Prov 23:11; 1 Sam 25:39
v24 — Prov 29:22; 2 Cor 6:14-17; Prov 21:24
v29 — 1 Kgs 11:28; Matt 25:21; Prov 12:24; Prov 10:4; Eccl 9:10

Chapter 23

The wise man warns against craving a ruler's delicacies, laboring only to be rich, eating the bread of a man with an evil eye, and the sorrow of those who linger long at the wine. He pleads with his son to give him his heart and to let his eyes observe the father's ways.

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| 1 | <i>When thou sittest to eat with a ruler, consider diligently what is before thee:</i> | When you sit down to eat with a ruler, consider diligently what is before you, |
| 2 | <i>And put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite.</i> | and put a knife to your throat if you are a man given to appetite. |

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| 3 | <i>Be not desirous of his dainties: for they are deceitful meat.</i> | Do not desire his delicacies, for they are deceitful food. |
| 4 | <i>Labour not to be rich: cease from thine own wisdom.</i> | Do not labor to be rich; cease from your own wisdom. |
| 5 | <i>Wilt thou set thine eyes upon that which is not? for riches certainly make themselves wings; they fly away as an eagle toward heaven.</i> | Will you set your eyes on what is not? For riches certainly make themselves wings; they fly away like an eagle toward heaven. |
| 6 | <i>Eat thou not the bread of him that hath an evil eye, neither desire thou his dainty meats:</i> | Do not eat the bread of him who has an evil eye, nor desire his delicacies, |
| 7 | <i>For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he: Eat and drink, saith he to thee; but his heart is not with thee.</i> | for as he thinks in his heart, so is he. "Eat and drink," he says to you, but his heart is not with you. |
| 8 | <i>The morsel which thou hast eaten shalt thou vomit up, and lose thy sweet words.</i> | The morsel you have eaten you will vomit up, and lose your sweet words. |
| 9 | <i>Speak not in the ears of a fool: for he will despise the wisdom of thy words.</i> | Do not speak in the ears of a fool, for he will despise the wisdom of your words. |
| 10 | <i>Remove not the old landmark; and enter not into the fields of the fatherless:</i> | Do not remove the old landmark, and do not enter the fields of the fatherless, |
| 11 | <i>For their redeemer is mighty; he shall plead their cause with thee.</i> | for their Redeemer is mighty; he will plead their cause against you. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption / Redeemer** (ree-DEM-shun / ree-DEE-mur) — *To buy back, to set free by paying a price. The Redeemer is the one who pays the price to deliver His people. Here God Himself is the mighty Redeemer of the fatherless.*

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| 12 | <i>Apply thine heart unto instruction, and thine ears to the words of knowledge.</i> | Apply your heart to instruction, and your ears to the words of knowledge. |
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| 13 <i>Withhold not correction from the child: for if thou beatest him with the rod, he shall not die.</i> | Do not withhold correction from a child, for if you strike him with the rod, he will not die. |
| 14 <i>Thou shalt beat him with the rod, and shalt deliver his soul from hell.</i> | You will strike him with the rod, and deliver his soul from hell. |
| 15 <i>My son, if thine heart be wise, my heart shall rejoice, even mine.</i> | My son, if your heart is wise, my heart will rejoice, indeed mine. |
| 16 <i>Yea, my reins shall rejoice, when thy lips speak right things.</i> | Yes, my inmost being will rejoice when your lips speak right things. |
| 17 <i>Let not thine heart envy sinners: but be thou in the fear of the LORD all the day long.</i> | Do not let Your heart envy sinners; but be in the fear of the LORD all the day long. |
| 18 <i>For surely there is an end; and thine expectation shall not be cut off.</i> | For surely there is an end, and Your expectation will not be cut off. |
| 19 <i>Hear thou, my son, and be wise, and guide thine heart in the way.</i> | Hear, my son, and be wise, and guide Your heart in the way. |
| 20 <i>Be not among winebibbers; among riotous eaters of flesh:</i> | Do not be among heavy drinkers, among gluttonous eaters of meat, |
| 21 <i>For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty: and drowsiness shall clothe a man with rags.</i> | for the drunkard and the glutton will come to poverty, and drowsiness will clothe a man with rags. |
| 22 <i>Hearken unto thy father that begat thee, and despise not thy mother when she is old.</i> | Listen to Your father who begot You, and do not despise Your mother when she is old. |
| 23 <i>Buy the truth, and sell it not; also wisdom, and instruction, and understanding.</i> | Buy the truth, and do not sell it; also wisdom, instruction, and understanding. |
| 24 <i>The father of the righteous shall greatly rejoice: and he that begetteth a wise child shall have joy of him.</i> | The father of the righteous will greatly rejoice, and he who begets a wise child will have joy in him. |
| 25 <i>Thy father and thy mother shall be glad, and she that bare thee shall rejoice.</i> | Your father and Your mother will be glad, and she who bore You will rejoice. |

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| <p>26 <i>My son, give me thine heart, and let thine eyes observe my ways.</i></p> <p>27 <i>For a whore is a deep ditch; and a strange woman is a narrow pit.</i></p> <p>28 <i>She also lieth in wait as for a prey, and increaseth the transgressors among men.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes?</i></p> <p>30 <i>They that tarry long at the wine; they that go to seek mixed wine.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright.</i></p> <p>32 <i>At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Thine eyes shall behold strange women, and thine heart shall utter perverse things.</i></p> <p>34 <i>Yea, thou shalt be as he that lieth down in the midst of the sea, or as he that lieth upon the top of a mast.</i></p> <p>35 <i>They have stricken me, shalt thou say, and I was not sick; they have beaten me, and I felt it not: when shall I awake? I will seek it yet again.</i></p> | <p>My son, give me Your heart, and let Your eyes observe my ways.</p> <p>For a harlot is a deep ditch, and a strange woman is a narrow pit.</p> <p>She also lies in wait as for prey, and increases the transgressors among men.</p> <p>Who has woe? Who has sorrow? Who has contentions? Who has babbling? Who has wounds without cause? Who has redness of eyes?</p> <p>Those who linger long at the wine, those who go to seek mixed wine.</p> <p>Do not look on the wine when it is red, when it gives its color in the cup, when it moves itself rightly.</p> <p>At the last, it bites like a serpent and stings like an adder.</p> <p>Your eyes will look on strange women, and Your heart will utter perverse things.</p> <p>Yes, You will be like one who lies down in the midst of the sea, or like one who lies on top of a mast.</p> <p>"They have struck me," you will say, "but I was not hurt; they have beaten me, but I felt it not. When will I awake? I will seek it yet again."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4 — Heb 13:5; Prov 28:20; Matt 6:19; 1 Tim 6:8-10; Prov 3:5
 v5 — Prov 27:24; 1 John 2:16; Matt 6:19; Jas 5:1-2; 1 Tim 6:17
 v7 — Ps 12:2; Ps 55:21; Judg 16:15; Matt 9:3-4; Luke 11:37-54

v12 — Prov 5:1-2; Prov 2:2-6; Jas 1:21-25; Prov 23:19; Ezek 33:31
v13 — Prov 13:24; Prov 29:15; Prov 19:18; Prov 29:17
v17 — Prov 28:14; 2 Cor 7:1; Prov 15:16; 1 Pet 1:17; Eccl 5:7
v18 — Heb 10:35; Jer 29:11; Ps 9:18; Phil 1:20; Prov 24:14
v21 — Prov 21:17; Prov 19:15; Phil 3:19; 1 Cor 5:11; Deut 21:20
v22 — Prov 30:17; Prov 1:8; John 19:26-27; Prov 6:20; Eph 6:1-2
v23 — Prov 18:15; Matt 13:44; Ps 119:72; Prov 16:16; Isa 55:1
v24 — Prov 10:1; Prov 15:20; Prov 23:15-16; Prov 29:3; Phlm 1:20
v26 — Ps 119:2; Ps 119:9-11; Deut 6:5; Matt 10:37-38; Prov 4:25-27

Chapter 24

The wise man warns against envying the wicked and counsels the value of wisdom, strength in adversity, and rescuing those being led to death. The chapter closes with the lesson of the sluggard's vineyard — overgrown and broken down — teaching that poverty comes like an armed man to the one who loves sleep.

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| 1 | <i>Be not thou envious against evil men, neither desire to be with them.</i> | Do not be envious of evil men, nor desire to be with them. |
| 2 | <i>For their heart studieth destruction, and their lips talk of mischief.</i> | For their heart studies destruction, and their lips talk of mischief. |
| 3 | <i>Through wisdom is an house builded; and by understanding it is established:</i> | Through wisdom a house is built, and by understanding it is established. |
| 4 | <i>And by knowledge shall the chambers be filled with all precious and pleasant riches.</i> | And by knowledge the chambers will be filled with all precious and pleasant riches. |
| 5 | <i>A wise man is strong; yea, a man of knowledge increaseth strength.</i> | A wise man is strong; indeed, a man of knowledge increases strength. |
| 6 | <i>For by wise counsel thou shalt make thy war; and in multitude of counsellors there is safety.</i> | For by wise counsel you will wage your war, and in the multitude of counselors there is safety. |
| 7 | <i>Wisdom is too high for a fool: he openeth not his mouth in the gate.</i> | Wisdom is too high for a fool; he does not open his mouth in the gate. |
| 8 | <i>He that deviseth to do evil shall be called a mischievous person.</i> | He who devises to do evil will be called a mischievous person. |
| 9 | <i>The thought of foolishness is sin: and the scorner is an abomination to men.</i> | The thought of foolishness is sin, and the scorner is an abomination to men. |

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| 10 <i>If thou faint in the day of adversity,
thy strength is small.</i> | If you faint in the day of adversity,
your strength is small. |
| 11 <i>If thou forbear to deliver them that
are drawn unto death, and those that
are ready to be slain;</i> | If you fail to deliver those who are
drawn to death, and those who are
ready to be slain — |
| 12 <i>If thou sayest, Behold, we knew it not;
doth not he that pondereth the heart
consider it? and he that keepeth thy
soul, doth not he know it? and shall
not he render to every man according
to his works?</i> | if you say, "We did not know it," does
not he who ponders the heart consider
it? And he who keeps your soul, does
he not know it? And will he not render
to every man according to his works? |
| 13 <i>My son, eat thou honey, because it is
good; and the honeycomb, which is
sweet to thy taste:</i> | My son, eat honey, because it is good,
and the honeycomb, which is sweet to
your taste. |
| 14 <i>So shall the knowledge of wisdom be
unto thy soul: when thou hast found it,
then there shall be a reward, and thy
expectation shall not be cut off.</i> | So will the knowledge of wisdom be to
your soul; when you have found it,
there will be a reward, and your
expectation will not be cut off. |
| 15 <i>Lay not wait, O wicked man, against
the dwelling of the righteous; spoil
not his resting place:</i> | Do not lie in wait, O wicked man,
against the dwelling of the righteous;
do not plunder his resting place. |
| 16 <i>For a just man falleth seven times,
and riseth up again: but the wicked
shall fall into mischief.</i> | For a just man falls seven times and
rises again; but the wicked will fall
into mischief. |
| 17 <i>Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth,
and let not thine heart be glad when
he stumbleth:</i> | Do not rejoice when your enemy falls,
and do not let your heart be glad when
he stumbles, |
| 18 <i>Lest the LORD see it, and it displease
him, and he turn away his wrath from
him.</i> | lest the LORD see it and it displease
Him, and He turn away His wrath from
Him. |
| 19 <i>Fret not thyself because of evil men,
neither be thou envious at the wicked:</i> | Do not fret yourself because of evil
men, nor be envious of the wicked, |

- 20 *For there shall be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked shall be put out.* for there will be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked will be put out.
- 21 *My son, fear thou the LORD and the king; and meddle not with them that are given to change:* My son, fear the LORD and the king, and do not associate with those who are given to change,
- 22 *For their calamity shall rise suddenly; and who knoweth the ruin of them both?* for their calamity will rise suddenly, and who knows the ruin of them both?
- 23 *These things also belong to the wise. It is not good to have respect of persons in judgment.* These things also belong to the wise: It is not good to show partiality in judgment.
- 24 *He that saith unto the wicked, Thou art righteous; him shall the people curse, nations shall abhor him:* He who says to the wicked, "You are righteous," him the people will curse, and nations will abhor him;
- 25 *But to them that rebuke him shall be delight, and a good blessing shall come upon them.* but to those who rebuke him there will be delight, and a good blessing will come on them.
- 26 *Every man shall kiss his lips that giveth a right answer.* Every man will kiss the lips of him who gives a right answer.
- 27 *Prepare thy work without, and make it fit for thyself in the field; and afterwards build thine house.* Prepare your work outside, and make it ready for yourself in the field; afterward build your house.
- 28 *Be not a witness against thy neighbour without cause; and deceive not with thy lips.* Do not be a witness against your neighbor without cause, and do not deceive with your lips.
- 29 *Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work.* Do not say, "I will do to him as he has done to me; I will repay the man according to his work."
- 30 *I went by the field of the slothful, and by the vineyard of the man void of understanding;* I went by the field of the slothful and by the vineyard of the man without understanding,

31	<i>And, lo, it was all grown over with thorns, and nettles had covered the face thereof, and the stone wall thereof was broken down.</i>	and it was all grown over with thorns, nettles had covered its surface, and its stone wall was broken down.
32	<i>Then I saw, and considered it well: I looked upon it, and received instruction.</i>	Then I saw and considered it well; I looked on it and received instruction.
33	<i>Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep:</i>	A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep —
34	<i>So shall thy poverty come as one that travelleth; and thy want as an armed man.</i>	so your poverty will come like a wanderer, and your need like an armed man.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 37:7; Prov 23:17; Prov 3:31; Jas 4:5-6; Gal 5:19-21
- v3 — Prov 14:1; Prov 9:1; 1 Cor 3:9; Col 2:7; Jer 10:12
- v4 — Prov 15:6; Prov 21:20; Prov 20:15; Prov 8:21
- v5 — Eccl 7:19; Col 1:11; Prov 21:22; Ps 84:7; Prov 8:14
- v6 — Prov 11:14; Prov 20:18; Eph 6:10-20; Prov 15:22; Luke 14:31
- v9 — Matt 15:19; 2 Cor 10:5; Acts 8:22; Isa 55:7; Prov 29:8
- v10 — Isa 40:28-31; Eph 3:13; Jer 51:46; Heb 12:3-5; 1 Sam 27:1
- v11 — Ps 82:4; Isa 58:6-7; 1 John 3:16-17; Job 29:17; 1 Sam 26:8-9
- v14 — Jas 1:25; Prov 2:10; Jer 15:16; Ps 119:103; Prov 23:18
- v16 — Ps 34:19; Ps 37:24; Mic 7:8-10; Job 5:19; 2 Cor 4:8-12
- v17 — Obad 1:12; Job 31:29; 1 Cor 13:6-7; Prov 17:5; 2 Sam 16:5-14
- v27 — Luke 14:28-30; 1 Kgs 5:17-18; 1 Kgs 6:7

Chapter 25

The Hezekiah collection begins with proverbs about conduct before kings, the value of a timely word, and the danger of false boasting. Memorable images abound: cold water to a weary soul, vinegar on a wound, coals of fire on an enemy's head, and a city without walls for the man who has no self-control.

1	<i>These are also proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.</i>	These are also proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.
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| 2 <i>It is the glory of God to conceal a thing; but the honour of kings is to search out a matter.</i> | It is the glory of God to conceal a thing; but the honor of kings is to search out a matter. |
| 3 <i>The heaven for height, and the earth for depth, and the heart of kings is unsearchable.</i> | The heaven for height, the earth for depth, and the heart of kings are unsearchable. |
| 4 <i>Take away the dross from the silver, and there shall come forth a vessel for the finer.</i> | Take away the dross from the silver, and there will come forth a vessel for the refiner. |
| 5 <i>Take away the wicked from before the king, and his throne shall be established in righteousness.</i> | Take away the wicked from before the king, and his throne will be established in righteousness. |
| 6 <i>Put not forth thyself in the presence of the king, and stand not in the place of great men:</i> | Do not exalt yourself in the presence of the king, and do not stand in the place of great men, |
| 7 <i>For better it is that it be said unto thee, Come up hither; than that thou shouldest be put lower in the presence of the prince whom thine eyes have seen.</i> | for it is better that it be said to you, "Come up here," than that you should be put lower in the presence of the prince whom your eyes have seen. |
| 8 <i>Go not forth hastily to strive, lest thou know not what to do in the end thereof, when thy neighbour hath put thee to shame.</i> | Do not go forth hastily to strive, lest you know not what to do in the end, when your neighbor has put you to shame. |
| 9 <i>Debate thy cause with thy neighbour himself; and discover not a secret to another:</i> | Debate your cause with your neighbor himself, and do not disclose a secret to another, |
| 10 <i>Lest he that heareth it put thee to shame, and thine infamy turn not away.</i> | lest he who hears it put you to shame, and your bad name not turn away. |
| 11 <i>A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver.</i> | A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in settings of silver. |

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| 12 <i>As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprover upon an obedient ear.</i> | Like an earring of gold and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprover to an obedient ear. |
| 13 <i>As the cold of snow in the time of harvest, so is a faithful messenger to them that send him: for he refresheth the soul of his masters.</i> | Like the cold of snow in the time of harvest is a faithful messenger to those who send him, for he refreshes the soul of his masters. |
| 14 <i>Whoso boasteth himself of a false gift is like clouds and wind without rain.</i> | Whoever boasts of a false gift is like clouds and wind without rain. |
| 15 <i>By long forbearing is a prince persuaded, and a soft tongue breaketh the bone.</i> | By long patience a prince is persuaded, and a soft tongue breaks the bone. |
| 16 <i>Hast thou found honey? eat so much as is sufficient for thee, lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it.</i> | Have you found honey? Eat only as much as is enough for you, lest you be filled with it and vomit. |
| 17 <i>Withdraw thy foot from thy neighbour's house; lest he be weary of thee, and so hate thee.</i> | Withdraw your foot from your neighbor's house, lest he be weary of you and so hate you. |
| 18 <i>A man that beareth false witness against his neighbour is a maul, and a sword, and a sharp arrow.</i> | A man who bears false witness against his neighbor is a club, a sword, and a sharp arrow. |
| 19 <i>Confidence in an unfaithful man in time of trouble is like a broken tooth, and a foot out of joint.</i> | Confidence in an unfaithful man in time of trouble is like a broken tooth and a foot out of joint. |
| 20 <i>As he that taketh away a garment in cold weather, and as vinegar upon nitre, so is he that singeth songs to an heavy heart.</i> | Like one who takes away a garment in cold weather, and like vinegar on soda, so is he who sings songs to a heavy heart. |
| 21 <i>If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink:</i> | If your enemy is hungry, give him bread to eat; if he is thirsty, give him water to drink. |
| 22 <i>For thou shalt heap coals of fire upon his head, and the LORD shall reward thee.</i> | For You will heap coals of fire on His head, and the LORD will reward You. |

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| <p>23 <i>The north wind driveth away rain: so doth an angry countenance a backbiting tongue.</i></p> <p>24 <i>It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman and in a wide house.</i></p> <p>25 <i>As cold waters to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a far country.</i></p> <p>26 <i>A righteous man falling down before the wicked is as a troubled fountain, and a corrupt spring.</i></p> <p>27 <i>It is not good to eat much honey: so for men to search their own glory is not glory.</i></p> <p>28 <i>He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls.</i></p> | <p>The north wind drives away rain, and so does an angry countenance a backbiting tongue.</p> <p>It is better to live in the corner of the housetop than with a contentious woman in a wide house.</p> <p>Like cold waters to a thirsty soul is good news from a far country.</p> <p>A righteous man falling down before the wicked is like a troubled fountain and a corrupt spring.</p> <p>It is not good to eat much honey, and for men to search their own glory is not glory.</p> <p>He who has no rule over his own spirit is like a city broken down and without walls.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 29:29; Rom 11:33-34; Job 11:7-8; Job 38:4-39:30; Job 42:3
- v4 — 2 Tim 2:20-21; Prov 17:3; Ezek 22:18; Isa 1:25-27; Mal 3:2-3
- v5 — Prov 20:8; Prov 16:12; Ps 101:7-8; Isa 16:5; Prov 20:28
- v6 — Prov 27:2; Prov 16:19; Prov 25:27
- v7 — Luke 14:7-11; Luke 18:14
- v8 — Matt 5:25; Prov 17:14; Prov 18:6; Prov 14:12; Prov 30:33
- v11 — Prov 15:23; Isa 50:4; Eccl 12:10; Prov 24:26
- v20 — Rom 12:15; Eccl 3:4
- v21 — Rom 12:20-21; Matt 5:44; Prov 24:17; Ex 23:4-5; Luke 10:33-36
- v24 — Prov 21:19; Prov 21:9; Prov 27:15-16
- v25 — Prov 15:30; Rom 10:15; Ps 63:1
- v28 — Prov 16:32; Prov 22:24; 2 Chr 32:5; Neh 1:3

Chapter 26

Contrasting proverbs address the fool (honor is not fitting for him, and answering him requires discernment), the sluggard who turns on his bed like a door on its hinges, and the danger of

deceit, gossip, and flattering lips. The meddler, the tale-bearer, and the man who hides hatred behind fair words are all exposed.

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| 1 | <i>As snow in summer, and as rain in harvest, so honour is not seemly for a fool.</i> | Like snow in summer and rain in harvest, so honor is not fitting for a fool. |
| 2 | <i>As the bird by wandering, as the swallow by flying, so the curse causeless shall not come.</i> | Like the bird that wanders and the swallow in flight, so a causeless curse will not come to rest. |
| 3 | <i>A whip for the horse, a bridle for the ass, and a rod for the fool's back.</i> | A whip for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the fool's back. |
| 4 | <i>Answer not a fool according to his folly, lest thou also be like unto him.</i> | Do not answer a fool according to his folly, lest you also be like him. |
| 5 | <i>Answer a fool according to his folly, lest he be wise in his own conceit.</i> | Answer a fool according to his folly, lest he be wise in his own conceit. |
| 6 | <i>He that sendeth a message by the hand of a fool cutteth off the feet, and drinketh damage.</i> | He who sends a message by the hand of a fool cuts off his own feet and drinks damage. |
| 7 | <i>The legs of the lame are not equal: so is a parable in the mouth of fools.</i> | The legs of the lame are not equal, and so is a parable in the mouth of fools. |
| 8 | <i>As he that bindeth a stone in a sling, so is he that giveth honour to a fool.</i> | Like one who binds a stone in a sling, so is he who gives honor to a fool. |
| 9 | <i>As a thorn goeth up into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools.</i> | Like a thorn that goes into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools. |
| 10 | <i>The great God that formed all things both rewardeth the fool, and rewardeth transgressors.</i> | The great God Who formed all things rewards both the fool and the transgressors. |
| 11 | <i>As a dog returneth to his vomit, so a fool returneth to his folly.</i> | As a dog returns to his vomit, so a fool returns to his folly. |
| 12 | <i>Seest thou a man wise in his own conceit? there is more hope of a fool than of him.</i> | Do you see a man wise in his own conceit? There is more hope for a fool than for him. |

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| 13 <i>The slothful man saith, There is a lion in the way; a lion is in the streets.</i> | The slothful man says, "There is a lion in the way; a lion is in the streets!" |
| 14 <i>As the door turneth upon his hinges, so doth the slothful upon his bed.</i> | As the door turns on its hinges, so does the slothful on his bed. |
| 15 <i>The slothful hideth his hand in his bosom; it grieveth him to bring it again to his mouth.</i> | The slothful hides his hand in his bosom; it grieves him to bring it again to his mouth. |
| 16 <i>The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason.</i> | The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men who can give a reason. |
| 17 <i>He that passeth by, and meddleth with strife belonging not to him, is like one that taketh a dog by the ears.</i> | He who passes by and meddles in a strife not belonging to him is like one who takes a dog by the ears. |
| 18 <i>As a mad man who casteth firebrands, arrows, and death,</i> | Like a madman who casts firebrands, arrows, and death, |
| 19 <i>So is the man that deceiveth his neighbour, and saith, Am not I in sport?</i> | so is the man who deceives his neighbor and says, "Am I not in sport?" |
| 20 <i>Where no wood is, there the fire goeth out: so where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth.</i> | Where there is no wood, the fire goes out, and where there is no talebearer, strife ceases. |
| 21 <i>As coals are to burning coals, and wood to fire; so is a contentious man to kindle strife.</i> | As coals are to burning coals, and wood to fire, so is a contentious man for kindling strife. |
| 22 <i>The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly.</i> | The words of a talebearer are like wounds, and they go down to the innermost parts of the belly. |
| 23 <i>Burning lips and a wicked heart are like a potsherd covered with silver dross.</i> | Burning lips and a wicked heart are like a potsherd covered with silver dross. |
| 24 <i>He that hateth dissembleth with his lips, and layeth up deceit within him;</i> | He who hates disguises it with his lips and stores up deceit within him; |

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| 25 | <i>When he speaketh fair, believe him not: for there are seven abominations in his heart.</i> | when he speaks fair words, do not believe him, for there are seven abominations in his heart. |
| 26 | <i>Whose hatred is covered by deceit, his wickedness shall be shewed before the whole congregation.</i> | Though his hatred is covered by deceit, his wickedness will be shown before the whole congregation. |
| 27 | <i>Whoso diggeth a pit shall fall therein: and he that rolleth a stone, it will return upon him.</i> | Whoever digs a pit will fall into it, and he who rolls a stone, it will return on him. |
| 28 | <i>A lying tongue hateth those that are afflicted by it; and a flattering mouth worketh ruin.</i> | A lying tongue hates those who are afflicted by it, and a flattering mouth works ruin. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Num 23:8; Neh 13:2; Ps 109:28; Deut 23:4-5; 2 Sam 16:12
v4 — Prov 26:5; 1 Pet 3:9
v5 — Matt 16:1-4; Rom 12:16
v6 — Prov 25:13; Prov 10:26; Prov 13:17
v11 — 2 Pet 2:22; Matt 12:45; Ex 8:15
v12 — Prov 29:20; 1 Cor 3:18-19; Prov 26:5; Rom 12:16; Prov 28:11
v13 — Prov 22:13; Prov 19:15
v17 — Prov 20:3; 2 Tim 2:23-24; Prov 18:6; Luke 12:14
v20 — Prov 16:28; Prov 22:10; Jas 3:6
v24 — Prov 12:20; Ps 41:6; Prov 10:18
v25 — Prov 6:16-19; Ps 28:3; Jer 12:6; Matt 24:23; Jer 9:2-8
v27 — Prov 28:10; Ps 9:15; Ps 7:15-16; Ps 10:2; Eccl 10:8

Chapter 27

Contrasting proverbs address the uncertainty of tomorrow, the value of open rebuke over hidden love, the sharpening of friend by friend as iron sharpens iron, and the restless stirring of envy. The chapter urges diligence in knowing the state of one's flocks, for riches do not endure forever.

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| 1 | <i>Boast not thyself of to morrow; for thou knowest not what a day may bring forth.</i> | Do not boast of tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring forth. |
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| 2 | <i>Let another man praise thee, and not thine own mouth; a stranger, and not thine own lips.</i> | Let another man praise you, and not your own mouth; a stranger, and not your own lips. |
| 3 | <i>A stone is heavy, and the sand weighty; but a fool's wrath is heavier than them both.</i> | A stone is heavy, and the sand weighty, but a fool's wrath is heavier than them both. |
| 4 | <i>Wrath is cruel, and anger is outrageous; but who is able to stand before envy?</i> | Wrath is cruel and anger is outrageous, but who is able to stand before envy? |
| 5 | <i>Open rebuke is better than secret love.</i> | Open rebuke is better than secret love. |
| 6 | <i>Faithful are the wounds of a friend; but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful.</i> | Faithful are the wounds of a friend, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful. |
| 7 | <i>The full soul loatheth an honeycomb; but to the hungry soul every bitter thing is sweet.</i> | The full soul loathes a honeycomb, but to the hungry soul every bitter thing is sweet. |
| 8 | <i>As a bird that wandereth from her nest, so is a man that wandereth from his place.</i> | As a bird that wanders from her nest, so is a man who wanders from his place. |
| 9 | <i>Ointment and perfume rejoice the heart: so doth the sweetness of a man's friend by hearty counsel.</i> | Ointment and perfume rejoice the heart, and so does the sweetness of a man's friend by hearty counsel. |
| 10 | <i>Thine own friend, and thy father's friend, forsake not; neither go into thy brother's house in the day of thy calamity: for better is a neighbour that is near than a brother far off.</i> | Do not forsake your own friend, or your father's friend, and do not go to your brother's house in the day of your calamity. Better is a neighbor who is near than a brother far off. |
| 11 | <i>My son, be wise, and make my heart glad, that I may answer him that reproacheth me.</i> | My son, be wise and make my heart glad, that I may answer him who reproaches me. |
| 12 | <i>A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself; but the simple pass on, and are punished.</i> | A prudent man foresees the evil and hides himself, but the simple pass on and are punished. |

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| 13 | <i>Take his garment that is surety for a stranger, and take a pledge of him for a strange woman.</i> | Take the garment of him who is surety for a stranger, and take a pledge from him for a strange woman. |
| 14 | <i>He that blesseth his friend with a loud voice, rising early in the morning, it shall be counted a curse to him.</i> | He who blesses his friend with a loud voice, rising early in the morning, it will be counted a curse to him. |
| 15 | <i>A continual dropping in a very rainy day and a contentious woman are alike.</i> | A continual dripping in a very rainy day and a contentious woman are alike. |
| 16 | <i>Whosoever hideth her hideth the wind, and the ointment of his right hand, which bewrayeth itself.</i> | Whoever hides her hides the wind, and the ointment of his right hand betrays itself. |
| 17 | <i>Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend.</i> | Iron sharpens iron, and so a man sharpens the countenance of his friend. |
| 18 | <i>Whoso keepeth the fig tree shall eat the fruit thereof: so he that waiteth on his master shall be honoured.</i> | Whoever keeps the fig tree will eat its fruit, and he who waits on his master will be honored. |
| 19 | <i>As in water face answereth to face, so the heart of man to man.</i> | As in water face answers to face, so the heart of man to man. |
| 20 | <i>Hell and destruction are never full; so the eyes of man are never satisfied.</i> | Hell and destruction are never full, and so the eyes of man are never satisfied. |
| 21 | <i>As the fining pot for silver, and the furnace for gold; so is a man to his praise.</i> | As the refining pot for silver, and the furnace for gold, so is a man tested by his praise. |
| 22 | <i>Though thou shouldest bray a fool in a mortar among wheat with a pestle, yet will not his foolishness depart from him.</i> | Though you should grind a fool in a mortar among wheat with a pestle, yet his foolishness will not depart from him. |
| 23 | <i>Be thou diligent to know the state of thy flocks, and look well to thy herds.</i> | Be diligent to know the state of your flocks, and look well to your herds, |
| 24 | <i>For riches are not for ever: and doth the crown endure to every generation?</i> | for riches are not forever, and does the crown endure to every generation? |

25	<i>The hay appeareth, and the tender grass sheweth itself, and herbs of the mountains are gathered.</i>	The hay appears, the tender grass shows itself, and the herbs of the mountains are gathered.
26	<i>The lambs are for thy clothing, and the goats are the price of the field.</i>	The lambs are for your clothing, and the goats are the price of the field.
27	<i>And thou shalt have goats' milk enough for thy food, for the food of thy household, and for the maintenance for thy maidens.</i>	You will have goats' milk enough for your food, for the food of your household, and for the maintenance of your maidens.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jas 4:13-16; Luke 12:19-20; 2 Cor 6:2
- v2 — 2 Cor 10:18; Prov 25:27; 2 Cor 10:12; 2 Cor 12:11
- v5 — Prov 28:23; 1 Tim 5:20; Gal 2:14; Matt 18:15
- v6 — Ps 141:5; Rev 3:19; Job 5:17-18; Prov 26:23-26; 2 Sam 12:7-15
- v8 — Prov 21:16; Isa 16:2; Jonah 1:3; 1 Cor 7:20; Jonah 1:10-17
- v15 — Prov 21:9; Prov 19:13; Prov 21:19; Prov 25:24
- v17 — Heb 10:24; Prov 27:9; Job 4:3-4; 1 Sam 23:16; 2 Tim 2:3
- v18 — 2 Tim 2:6; 1 Cor 9:7; Song 8:12; Luke 12:37; John 12:26
- v19 — Jas 1:22-25; Ps 33:15; Mark 7:21; Gen 6:5
- v20 — Eccl 1:8; 1 John 2:16; Prov 30:15-16; Eccl 6:7; Hab 2:5
- v22 — Jer 5:3; Prov 23:35; Isa 1:5; Rev 16:10-11
- v23 — 1 Pet 5:2; John 21:15-17; 2 Chr 26:10; Gen 33:13; Prov 24:32

Chapter 28

Contrasting proverbs address the boldness of the righteous versus the flight of the wicked, the ruler who oppresses the poor, and the blessings that come to the faithful versus the haste that leads to poverty. He who trusts in his own heart is a fool, but whoever walks wisely will be delivered.

1	<i>The wicked flee when no man pursueth: but the righteous are bold as a lion.</i>	The wicked flee when no one pursues; but the righteous are as bold as a lion.
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| 2 | <i>For the transgression of a land many are the princes thereof; but by a man of understanding and knowledge the state thereof shall be prolonged.</i> | For the transgression of a land, its princes are many; but by a man of understanding and knowledge, its state will be prolonged. |
| 3 | <i>A poor man that oppresseth the poor is like a sweeping rain which leaveth no food.</i> | A poor man who oppresses the poor is like a sweeping rain which leaves no food. |
| 4 | <i>They that forsake the law praise the wicked: but such as keep the law contend with them.</i> | Those who forsake the law praise the wicked; but those who keep the law contend with them. |
| 5 | <i>Evil men understand not judgment: but they that seek the LORD understand all things.</i> | Evil men do not understand judgment; but those who seek the LORD understand all things. |
| 6 | <i>Better is the poor that walketh in his uprightness, than he that is perverse in his ways, though he be rich.</i> | Better is the poor who walks in His uprightness than He who is perverse in his ways, though he be rich. |
| 7 | <i>Whoso keepeth the law is a wise son: but he that is a companion of riotous men shameth his father.</i> | Whoever keeps the law is a wise son; but he who is a companion of riotous men shames his father. |
| 8 | <i>He that by usury and unjust gain increaseth his substance, he shall gather it for him that will pity the poor.</i> | He who by usury and unjust gain increases his substance will gather it for Him who will pity the poor. |
| 9 | <i>He that turneth away his ear from hearing the law, even his prayer shall be abomination.</i> | He who turns away his ear from hearing the law, even His prayer will be an abomination. |
| 10 | <i>Whoso causeth the righteous to go astray in an evil way, he shall fall himself into his own pit: but the upright shall have good things in possession.</i> | Whoever causes the righteous to go astray in an evil way will himself fall into His own pit; but the upright will have good things in possession. |
| 11 | <i>The rich man is wise in his own conceit; but the poor that hath understanding searcheth him out.</i> | The rich man is wise in his own conceit, but the poor who has understanding sees through him. |

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| 12 <i>When righteous men do rejoice, there is great glory: but when the wicked rise, a man is hidden.</i> | When righteous men rejoice, there is great glory; but when the wicked rise, men hide themselves. |
| 13 <i>He that covereth his sins shall not prosper: but whoso confesseth and forsaketh them shall have mercy.</i> | He who covers his sins will not prosper; but whoever confesses and forsakes them will have mercy. |
| 14 <i>Happy is the man that feareth always: but he that hardeneth his heart shall fall into mischief.</i> | Happy is the man who fears always; but he who hardens his heart will fall into mischief. |
| 15 <i>As a roaring lion, and a ranging bear; so is a wicked ruler over the poor people.</i> | Like a roaring lion and a charging bear, so is a wicked ruler over a poor people. |
| 16 <i>The prince that wanteth understanding is also a great oppressor: but he that hateth covetousness shall prolong his days.</i> | The prince who lacks understanding is also a great oppressor; but he who hates covetousness will prolong his days. |
| 17 <i>A man that doeth violence to the blood of any person shall flee to the pit; let no man stay him.</i> | A man who does violence to the blood of any person will flee to the pit; let no man hold him back. |
| 18 <i>Whoso walketh uprightly shall be saved: but he that is perverse in his ways shall fall at once.</i> | Whoever walks uprightly will be saved; but he who is perverse in his ways will fall at once. |
| 19 <i>He that tilleth his land shall have plenty of bread: but he that followeth after vain persons shall have poverty enough.</i> | He who tills his land will have plenty of bread; but he who follows worthless persons will have poverty enough. |
| 20 <i>A faithful man shall abound with blessings: but he that maketh haste to be rich shall not be innocent.</i> | A faithful man will abound with blessings; but he who hastens to be rich will not be innocent. |
| 21 <i>To have respect of persons is not good: for for a piece of bread that man will transgress.</i> | To show partiality is not good, for a piece of bread that man will transgress. |

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| 22 <i>He that hasteth to be rich hath an evil eye, and considereth not that poverty shall come upon him.</i> | He who hastens to be rich has an evil eye and does not consider that poverty will come on him. |
| 23 <i>He that rebuketh a man afterwards shall find more favour than he that flattereth with the tongue.</i> | He who rebukes a man will afterward find more favor than he who flatters with the tongue. |
| 24 <i>Whoso robbeth his father or his mother, and saith, It is no transgression; the same is the companion of a destroyer.</i> | Whoever robs his father or his mother and says, "It is no transgression," is the companion of a destroyer. |
| 25 <i>He that is of a proud heart stirreth up strife: but he that putteth his trust in the LORD shall be made fat.</i> | He who is of a proud heart stirs up strife; but he who puts his trust in the LORD will be made rich. |
| 26 <i>He that trusteth in his own heart is a fool: but whoso walketh wisely, he shall be delivered.</i> | He who trusts in his own heart is a fool; but whoever walks wisely will be delivered. |
| 27 <i>He that giveth unto the poor shall not lack: but he that hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.</i> | He who gives to the poor will not lack; but he who hides his eyes will have many a curse. |
| 28 <i>When the wicked rise, men hide themselves: but when they perish, the righteous increase.</i> | When the wicked rise, men hide themselves; but when they perish, the righteous increase. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Deut 28:7; Ps 53:5; Isa 26:3-4; Ps 27:1-2; Ps 112:7
v4 — Rom 1:32; Eph 5:11; Matt 14:4; Matt 3:7; Ps 49:18
v5 — Jas 1:5; Ps 92:6; 1 John 2:20; 1 John 2:27; John 7:17
v8 — Job 27:16-17; Prov 13:22; Eccl 2:26; Lev 25:36; Ex 22:25
v9 — Ps 66:18; 2 Tim 4:3-4; Zech 7:11-13; Prov 15:8; Ps 109:7
v13 — 1 John 1:8-10; Ps 32:3-5; Job 31:33; Luke 15:18-24; Jer 3:12-13
v14 — Prov 23:17; Ps 2:11; Isa 66:2; Jer 32:40; Rom 11:20
v18 — Prov 10:9; Prov 28:6; Rev 3:3; Ps 84:11; Prov 11:3-6
v20 — Luke 16:10-12; Prov 13:11; Rev 2:10; Ps 112:4-9; Prov 10:6
v25 — Prov 11:25; 1 Tim 6:6; Prov 13:4; Prov 10:12; Prov 13:10
v26 — Prov 3:5; Jer 17:9; Job 28:28; Rom 8:7; Jas 1:5

v27 — Prov 19:17; Ps 41:1-3; Prov 11:24; Deut 15:7; 2 Cor 9:6-11

Chapter 29

Contrasting proverbs address the ruler who loves justice versus the ruler who listens to lies, the rod of correction that gives wisdom versus the child left to himself who brings shame, and the fear of man that brings a snare versus trust in the LORD that brings safety. Where there is no vision, the people perish.

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| 1 | <i>He, that being often reprov'd
hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be
destroyed, and that without remedy.</i> | He who, being often corrected, hardens
his neck will suddenly be destroyed,
and that without remedy. |
| 2 | <i>When the righteous are in authority,
the people rejoice: but when the
wicked beareth rule, the people
mourn.</i> | When the righteous are in authority,
the people rejoice; but when the
wicked rule, the people mourn. |
| 3 | <i>Whoso loveth wisdom rejoiceth his
father: but he that keepeth company
with harlots spendeth his substance.</i> | Whoever loves wisdom rejoices his
father; but he who keeps company with
harlots wastes his substance. |
| 4 | <i>The king by judgment establisheth the
land: but he that receiveth gifts
overthroweth it.</i> | The king by judgment establishes the
land; but he who receives bribes
overthrows it. |
| 5 | <i>A man that flattereth his neighbour
spreadeth a net for his feet.</i> | A man who flatters his neighbor
spreads a net for his feet. |
| 6 | <i>In the transgression of an evil man
there is a snare: but the righteous
doth sing and rejoice.</i> | In the transgression of an evil man
there is a snare; but the righteous sings
and rejoices. |
| 7 | <i>The righteous considereth the cause
of the poor: but the wicked regardeth
not to know it.</i> | The righteous considers the cause of
the poor; but the wicked does not care
to know it. |
| 8 | <i>Scornful men bring a city into a
snare: but wise men turn away wrath.</i> | Scornful men bring a city into a snare;
but wise men turn away wrath. |
| 9 | <i>If a wise man contendeth with a
foolish man, whether he rage or
laugh, there is no rest.</i> | If a wise man contends with a foolish
man, whether he rages or laughs, there
is no rest. |

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| 10 | <i>The bloodthirsty hate the upright: but the just seek his soul.</i> | The bloodthirsty hate the upright; but the just seek his soul. |
| 11 | <i>A fool uttereth all his mind: but a wise man keepeth it in till afterwards.</i> | A fool utters all his mind; but a wise man keeps it in till afterward. |
| 12 | <i>If a ruler hearken to lies, all his servants are wicked.</i> | If a ruler listens to lies, all his servants become wicked. |
| 13 | <i>The poor and the deceitful man meet together: the LORD lighteneth both their eyes.</i> | The poor and the deceitful man meet together; the LORD enlightens the eyes of both. |
| 14 | <i>The king that faithfully judgeth the poor, his throne shall be established for ever.</i> | The king who faithfully judges the poor, his throne will be established forever. |
| 15 | <i>The rod and reproof give wisdom: but a child left to himself bringeth his mother to shame.</i> | The rod and reproof give wisdom; but a child left to himself brings his mother to shame. |
| 16 | <i>When the wicked are multiplied, transgression increaseth: but the righteous shall see their fall.</i> | When the wicked are multiplied, transgression increases; but the righteous will see their fall. |
| 17 | <i>Correct thy son, and he shall give thee rest; yea, he shall give delight unto thy soul.</i> | Correct your son, and he will give you rest; indeed, he will give delight to your soul. |
| 18 | <i>Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keepeth the law, happy is he.</i> | Where there is no vision, the people perish; but he who keeps the law, happy is he. |
| 19 | <i>A servant will not be corrected by words: for though he understand he will not answer.</i> | A servant will not be corrected by words, for though he understands, he will not answer. |
| 20 | <i>Seest thou a man that is hasty in his words? there is more hope of a fool than of him.</i> | Do you see a man who is hasty in his words? There is more hope for a fool than for him. |
| 21 | <i>He that delicately bringeth up his servant from a child shall have him become his son at the length.</i> | He who delicately raises his servant from a child will have him become his son in the end. |

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| 22 | <i>An angry man stirreth up strife, and a furious man aboundeth in transgression.</i> | An angry man stirs up strife, and a furious man abounds in transgression. |
| 23 | <i>A man's pride shall bring him low: but honour shall uphold the humble in spirit.</i> | A man's pride will bring him low; but honor will uphold the humble in spirit. |
| 24 | <i>Whoso is partner with a thief hateth his own soul: he heareth cursing, and bewrayeth it not.</i> | Whoever is partner with a thief hates his own soul; he hears cursing and does not reveal it. |
| 25 | <i>The fear of man bringeth a snare: but whoso putteth his trust in the LORD shall be safe.</i> | The fear of man brings a snare; but whoever puts his trust in the LORD will be safe. |
| 26 | <i>Many seek the ruler's favour; but every man's judgment cometh from the LORD.</i> | Many seek the ruler's favor, but every man's judgment comes from the LORD. |
| 27 | <i>An unjust man is an abomination to the just: and he that is upright in the way is abomination to the wicked.</i> | An unjust man is an abomination to the just, and he who is upright in the way is an abomination to the wicked. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 6:15; 1 Sam 2:25; Prov 1:24-31; Prov 28:18; Zech 7:11-14
v2 — Prov 28:12; Prov 11:10; Prov 28:28; Esth 8:15; Eccl 10:5
v7 — Job 29:16; Ps 41:1; Prov 21:13; Prov 31:8-9
v11 — Prov 19:11; Prov 12:16; Mic 7:5; Amos 5:13; Prov 12:23
v15 — Prov 10:1; Prov 17:25; Prov 29:17; Prov 13:24; Prov 22:15
v16 — Ps 58:10; Ps 92:11; Ps 37:36; Ps 91:8; Ps 37:34
v18 — Jas 1:25; Luke 11:28; Hos 4:6; John 13:17; Ps 1:1-2
v20 — Prov 26:12; Jas 1:19; Prov 14:29; Eccl 5:2; Prov 29:11
v22 — Prov 15:18; Prov 17:19; Prov 26:21; Prov 10:12; Prov 14:17
v23 — Matt 23:12; Luke 14:11; Prov 11:2; Isa 66:2; Jas 4:6-10
v25 — Ps 118:8; Luke 12:4; Prov 18:10; Ps 91:14; Prov 16:20
v26 — Prov 19:6; Ps 20:9; Prov 19:21; Isa 46:9-11; Ps 62:12

Chapter 30

Agur speaks of his own ignorance before God, asks who has ascended into heaven, and prays for neither poverty nor riches. He catalogues the wonders of creation in numbered proverbs — things too wonderful, things never satisfied, things that are stately in their stride — exposing human pride against the backdrop of God's inscrutable works.

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| <p>1 <i>The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, even the prophecy: the man spake unto Ithiel, even unto Ithiel and Ucal,</i></p> | <p>The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, even the prophecy. The man said to Ithiel, even to Ithiel and Ucal:</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Agur** (AY-gur) — "gatherer" — Son of Jakeh; an otherwise unknown wise man whose words make up chapter 30. His humble confession ("I am more brutish than any man") and his prayer for neither poverty nor riches (30:7–9) are among the most striking passages in Proverbs.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jakeh** (JAY-keh) — Father of Agur. Nothing else is known of him. His name appears only here in all of Scripture.

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| <p>2 <i>Surely I am more brutish than any man, and have not the understanding of a man.</i></p> | <p>Surely I am more brutish than any man, and do not have the understanding of a man.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>I neither learned wisdom, nor have the knowledge of the holy.</i></p> | <p>I have neither learned wisdom, nor have the knowledge of the Holy One.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Who hath ascended up into heaven, or descended? who hath gathered the wind in his fists? who hath bound the waters in a garment? who hath established all the ends of the earth? what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?</i></p> | <p>Who has ascended up into heaven, or descended? Who has gathered the wind in His fists? Who has bound the waters in a garment? Who has established all the ends of the earth? What is His name, and what is His son's name, if You can tell?</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him.</i></p> | <p>Every word of God is pure; He is a shield to those who put their trust in Him.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.</i></p> | <p>Do not add to His words, lest He rebuke You and You be found a liar.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Two things have I required of thee; deny me them not before I die:</i></p> | <p>Two things I have asked of You; do not deny them to me before I die:</p> |

- 8 *Remove far from me vanity and lies; give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with food convenient for me:* Remove far from me vanity and lies; give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with the food that is needful for me,
- 9 *Lest I be full, and deny thee, and say, Who is the LORD? or lest I be poor, and steal, and take the name of my God in vain.* lest I be full and deny You, and say, "Who is the LORD?" or lest I be poor and steal, and take the name of my God in vain.
- 10 *Accuse not a servant unto his master, lest he curse thee, and thou be found guilty.* Do not accuse a servant to His master, lest He curse You, and You be found guilty.
- 11 *There is a generation that curseth their father, and doth not bless their mother.* There is a generation that curses their father and does not bless their mother.
- 12 *There is a generation that are pure in their own eyes, and yet is not washed from their filthiness.* There is a generation that is pure in their own eyes, yet is not washed from their filthiness.
- 13 *There is a generation, O how lofty are their eyes! and their eyelids are lifted up.* There is a generation, O how lofty are their eyes, and their eyelids are lifted up!
- 14 *There is a generation, whose teeth are as swords, and their jaw teeth as knives, to devour the poor from off the earth, and the needy from among men.* There is a generation whose teeth are like swords, and their jaw teeth like knives, to devour the poor from off the earth, and the needy from among men.
- 15 *The horseleach hath two daughters, crying, Give, give. There are three things that are never satisfied, yea, four things say not, It is enough:* The leech has two daughters, crying, "Give, give." There are three things that are never satisfied, indeed four things that do not say, "It is enough":
- 16 *The grave; and the barren womb; the earth that is not filled with water; and the fire that saith not, It is enough.* the grave, the barren womb, the earth that is not filled with water, and the fire that does not say, "It is enough."

- 17 *The eye that mocketh at his father, and despiseth to obey his mother, the ravens of the valley shall pick it out, and the young eagles shall eat it.* The eye that mocks at His father and despises to obey His mother, the ravens of the valley will pick it out, and the young eagles will eat it.
- 18 *There be three things which are too wonderful for me, yea, four which I know not:* There are three things which are too wonderful for me, indeed four which I do not know:
- 19 *The way of an eagle in the air; the way of a serpent upon a rock; the way of a ship in the midst of the sea; and the way of a man with a maid.* the way of an eagle in the air, the way of a serpent on a rock, the way of a ship in the midst of the sea, and the way of a man with a maid.
- 20 *Such is the way of an adulterous woman; she eateth, and wipeth her mouth, and saith, I have done no wickedness.* Such is the way of an adulterous woman: she eats and wipes her mouth, and says, "I have done no wickedness."
- 21 *For three things the earth is disquieted, and for four which it cannot bear:* For three things the earth is disquieted, and for four which it cannot bear:
- 22 *For a servant when he reigneth; and a fool when he is filled with meat;* for a servant when He reigns, and a fool when He is filled with food,
- 23 *For an odious woman when she is married; and an handmaid that is heir to her mistress.* for a hateful woman when she is married, and a handmaid who is heir to her mistress.
- 24 *There be four things which are little upon the earth, but they are exceeding wise:* There are four things which are little on the earth, but they are exceedingly wise:
- 25 *The ants are a people not strong, yet they prepare their meat in the summer;* the ants are a people not strong, yet they prepare their food in the summer;
- 26 *The conies are but a feeble folk, yet make they their houses in the rocks;* the conies are a feeble folk, yet they make their houses in the rocks;
- 27 *The locusts have no king, yet go they forth all of them by bands;* the locusts have no king, yet all of them go forth in bands;

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| 28 | <i>The spider taketh hold with her hands, and is in kings' palaces.</i> | the spider takes hold with her hands, and is in kings' palaces. |
| 29 | <i>There be three things which go well, yea, four are comely in going:</i> | There are three things which go well, indeed four are graceful in their going: |
| 30 | <i>A lion which is strongest among beasts, and turneth not away for any;</i> | a lion, which is strongest among beasts and does not turn away for any; |
| 31 | <i>A greyhound; an he goat also; and a king, against whom there is no rising up.</i> | a greyhound, a male goat also, and a king against whom there is no rising up. |
| 32 | <i>If thou hast done foolishly in lifting up thyself, or if thou hast thought evil, lay thine hand upon thy mouth.</i> | If You have done foolishly in lifting up Yourself, or if You have thought evil, lay Your hand on Your mouth. |
| 33 | <i>Surely the churning of milk bringeth forth butter, and the wringing of the nose bringeth forth blood: so the forcing of wrath bringeth forth strife.</i> | Surely the churning of milk brings forth butter, and the wringing of the nose brings forth blood; so the forcing of wrath brings forth strife. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4** — John 3:13; Eph 4:8-10; Job 26:8; Deut 30:12; Isa 7:14
v5 — Ps 18:30; Jas 3:17; Ps 12:6; Ps 3:3; Ps 84:11
v6 — Deut 12:32; Deut 4:2; Rev 22:18-19; Job 13:7-9
v7 — Ps 27:4; Luke 10:42; 2 Kgs 2:9
v8 — 1 Tim 6:6-8; Ps 62:9-10; Ps 119:37; Matt 6:33; Luke 11:3
v9 — Hos 13:6; Deut 31:20; Ezek 16:49-50; Deut 8:10-14; Job 31:24-28
v11 — Prov 20:20; Prov 30:17; Prov 30:12-14; Deut 27:16; Ex 21:17
v12 — Luke 18:11; Prov 16:2; 2 Tim 3:5; Jer 2:35; 1 John 1:7-10
v14 — Ps 57:4; Ps 3:7; Ps 14:4; Job 29:17
v15 — Prov 30:21; Prov 6:16; Prov 30:29; Rom 16:18
v16 — Prov 27:20; Hab 2:5
v17 — Deut 21:18-21; Prov 30:11; Prov 23:22; 2 Sam 18:14-17; Lev 20:9

Chapter 31

King Lemuel's mother teaches him to avoid women and wine, to open his mouth for the voiceless and judge righteously for the poor, and the chapter closes with the acrostic portrait of the virtuous woman whose price is far above rubies. She works willingly, provides for her

household, stretches out her hand to the poor, and fears the LORD — and her works praise her in the gates.

- 1

The words of king Lemuel, the prophecy that his mother taught him.
- The words of King Lemuel, the prophecy that His mother taught Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lemuel** (LEM-yoo-el) — "devoted to God" — An otherwise unknown king whose mother's prophecy makes up the first nine verses of chapter 31. Some ancient commentators identified him with Solomon, but Scripture does not confirm this. His name appears only here.

- 2

What, my son? and what, the son of my womb? and what, the son of my vows?
- What, my son? And what, the son of my womb? And what, the son of my vows?
- 3

Give not thy strength unto women, nor thy ways to that which destroyeth kings.
- Do not give Your strength to women, nor Your ways to that which destroys kings.
- 4

It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink:
- It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine, nor for princes strong drink,
- 5

Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted.
- lest they drink and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted.
- 6

Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts.
- Give strong drink to Him who is ready to perish, and wine to those who are of heavy hearts.
- 7

Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more.
- Let Him drink and forget His poverty, and remember His misery no more.
- 8

Open thy mouth for the dumb in the cause of all such as are appointed to destruction.
- Open Your mouth for the mute in the cause of all such as are appointed to destruction.
- 9

Open thy mouth, judge righteously, and plead the cause of the poor and needy.
- Open Your mouth, judge righteously, and plead the cause of the poor and needy.
- 10

Who can find a virtuous woman? for her price is far above rubies.
- Who can find a virtuous woman? For her price is far above rubies.

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| 11 | <i>The heart of her husband doth safely trust in her, so that he shall have no need of spoil.</i> | The heart of her husband safely trusts in her, so that He will have no need of spoil. |
| 12 | <i>She will do him good and not evil all the days of her life.</i> | She will do Him good and not evil all the days of her life. |
| 13 | <i>She seeketh wool, and flax, and worketh willingly with her hands.</i> | She seeks wool and flax, and works willingly with her hands. |
| 14 | <i>She is like the merchants' ships; she bringeth her food from afar.</i> | She is like the merchants' ships; she brings her food from afar. |
| 15 | <i>She riseth also while it is yet night, and giveth meat to her household, and a portion to her maidens.</i> | She rises also while it is yet night, and gives food to her household, and a portion to her maidens. |
| 16 | <i>She considereth a field, and buyeth it: with the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard.</i> | She considers a field and buys it; with the fruit of her hands she plants a vineyard. |
| 17 | <i>She girdeth her loins with strength, and strengtheneth her arms.</i> | She girds her loins with strength, and strengthens her arms. |
| 18 | <i>She perceiveth that her merchandise is good: her candle goeth not out by night.</i> | She sees that her merchandise is good; her candle does not go out by night. |
| 19 | <i>She layeth her hands to the spindle, and her hands hold the distaff.</i> | She lays her hands to the spindle, and her hands hold the distaff. |
| 20 | <i>She stretcheth out her hand to the poor; yea, she reacheth forth her hands to the needy.</i> | She stretches out her hand to the poor; indeed, she reaches forth her hands to the needy. |
| 21 | <i>She is not afraid of the snow for her household: for all her household are clothed with scarlet.</i> | She is not afraid of the snow for her household, for all her household are clothed with scarlet. |
| 22 | <i>She maketh herself coverings of tapestry; her clothing is silk and purple.</i> | She makes herself coverings of tapestry; her clothing is silk and purple. |

23	<i>Her husband is known in the gates, when he sitteth among the elders of the land.</i>	Her husband is known in the gates, when He sits among the elders of the land.
24	<i>She maketh fine linen, and selleth it; and delivereth girdles unto the merchant.</i>	She makes fine linen and sells it, and delivers sashes to the merchant.
25	<i>Strength and honour are her clothing; and she shall rejoice in time to come.</i>	Strength and honor are her clothing, and she will rejoice in time to come.
26	<i>She openeth her mouth with wisdom; and in her tongue is the law of kindness.</i>	She opens her mouth with wisdom, and on her tongue is the law of kindness.
27	<i>She looketh well to the ways of her household, and eateth not the bread of idleness.</i>	She looks well to the ways of her household, and does not eat the bread of idleness.
28	<i>Her children arise up, and call her blessed; her husband also, and he praiseth her.</i>	Her children rise up and call her blessed; her husband also, and He praises her:
29	<i>Many daughters have done virtuously, but thou excellest them all.</i>	"Many daughters have done virtuously, but You excel them all."
30	<i>Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised.</i>	Favor is deceitful and beauty is vain; but a woman who fears the LORD, she will be praised.
31	<i>Give her of the fruit of her hands; and let her own works praise her in the gates.</i>	Give her of the fruit of her hands, and let her own works praise her in the gates.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v3 — Deut 17:17; Neh 13:26; Prov 7:26-27; Prov 5:9-11; 1 Kgs 11:1

v4 — Prov 20:1; Isa 5:22; Eccl 10:17; Hos 4:11-12; 1 Kgs 20:16-20

v8 — Ps 82:3-4; Prov 24:11-12

v9 — Isa 1:17; Amos 5:11-12; Lev 19:15; Job 29:15-16; Deut 1:16

v10 — Prov 19:14; Prov 12:4; Prov 18:22; Eph 5:25-33; Prov 3:15

v11 — 1 Pet 3:1-7

v25 — Job 40:10; Rom 13:14; Isa 61:10; Eph 4:24; Job 29:14

v26 — Eph 4:29; Prov 16:24; Prov 10:31; Prov 12:18; Col 4:5

v27 — 1 Tim 5:10; Titus 2:4; 2 Thess 3:6; Prov 14:1; 1 Thess 4:11

v28 — 2 Tim 3:15-17; 2 Tim 1:5; 1 Kgs 2:19; Prov 31:1; Ps 116:16

v30 — Prov 1:7; 1 Pet 3:4-5; Prov 11:22; Prov 8:13; 1 Pet 1:24

v31 — Ps 128:2; Heb 6:10; Matt 7:16; Rev 14:13; Rom 16:1-4

Ecclesiastes

Author: Solomon — called "the Preacher" (Hebrew Qoheleth). He identifies himself as "the son of David, king in Jerusalem" in 1:1, and his unmatched wisdom, wealth, and building projects (chapters 1–2) match the biblical portrait of Solomon exactly.

Date written: c. 935 BC, late in Solomon's reign — after a lifetime of unparalleled wisdom, wealth, pleasure, and achievement had shown him that none of these things satisfy apart from God.

Written to: Israel, and all who seek meaning in life. The Preacher addresses "the sons of men" throughout the book; his conclusions are universal.

Setting: Solomon looks back over everything he has pursued — wisdom, pleasure, labor, riches, fame — and delivers his verdict: "Vanity of vanities; all is vanity." The Hebrew word *hebel* (translated "vanity" in the KJV) means "breath" or "vapor" — something that appears for a moment and then vanishes. The book is not despair; it is realism. Every earthly pursuit is fleeting, but God's work endures forever. The Preacher's final answer is not emptiness but reverence: "Fear God, and keep his commandments."

Where this sits historically: Written near the end of Solomon's reign (c. 935 BC), shortly before the kingdom divided in 930 BC under his son Rehoboam, and while the Egyptian, Phoenician, and early Aramean kingdoms surrounded a Jerusalem at its zenith.

Contemporaries: Solomon composed it alongside Proverbs and the Song of Solomon, while Jeroboam was beginning to rise in the north and the prophet Ahijah of Shiloh was already announcing the coming division of the kingdom.

Big themes:

- The vanity of all earthly pursuits — wisdom, pleasure, labor, and wealth all end in the same grave
- The fear of God as life's conclusion — the book's answer to its own question (12:13–14)
- The limits of human wisdom — even the wisest man cannot find out all that God does (3:11; 8:17)
- The certainty of death as the great leveler — one event happens to the righteous and the wicked alike (9:2–3)
- Enjoyment of life as God's gift within its proper bounds — eating, drinking, and finding good in one's labor are from the hand of God (2:24; 3:13; 5:18–19)
- Time and seasons — God has appointed a time for everything, and everything is beautiful in its time (3:1–11)

Key passages: 1:2; 3:1–8; 5:2; 7:29; 12:1; 12:13–14

How it fits: Ecclesiastes is the counterweight to Proverbs. Proverbs teaches that wisdom, diligence, and the fear of the LORD lead to prosperity and blessing. Ecclesiastes answers: even prosperity is vanity without God. Together the two books give a complete picture —

pursue wisdom, work hard, enjoy God's gifts, but hold it all loosely, because nothing under the sun lasts. Only what God does endures forever.

Chapter 1

The Preacher declares that all is vanity and that there is nothing new under the sun. He introduces himself as king over Israel in Jerusalem and recounts how he set his heart to search out all things by wisdom, finding that even wisdom itself brings grief and sorrow.

- 1

The words of the Preacher, the son of David, king in Jerusalem.

The words of the Preacher, the son of David, king in Jerusalem.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Solomon / the Preacher** (SOL-oh-mun / PREE-chur) — Solomon, son of David, king of Israel, the wisest and wealthiest man of his age. The Hebrew title Qoheleth means "one who assembles" or "the Preacher" — one who gathers people to hear wisdom. Solomon does not name himself directly in Ecclesiastes but identifies himself by his office and lineage in 1:1 and 1:12.

- 2

Vanity of vanities, saith the Preacher, vanity of vanities; all is vanity.

"Vanity of vanities," says the Preacher, "vanity of vanities; all is vanity."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Vanity** (VAN-ih-tee) — Hebrew hebel, meaning "breath, vapor, fleeting." The KJV's "vanity of vanities" is the Preacher's verdict on all earthly striving apart from God. The word does not mean "pointless" in the modern slang sense — it means temporary, like a breath that appears and vanishes. This is the most repeated word in Ecclesiastes (appearing over 30 times) and the key to the whole book.

- 3

What profit hath a man of all his labour which he taketh under the sun?

What does a man gain from all his labor at which he works under the sun?
- 4

One generation passeth away, and another generation cometh: but the earth abideth for ever.

One generation passes away, and another generation comes, but the earth remains forever.
- 5

The sun also ariseth, and the sun goeth down, and hasteth to his place where he arose.

The sun also rises, and the sun goes down, and hurries back to the place where it rose.
- 6

The wind goeth toward the south, and turneth about unto the north; it whirleth about continually, and the wind returneth again according to his circuits.

The wind goes toward the south and turns about to the north. It whirls about continually, and the wind returns again on its circuits.

- 7 *All the rivers run into the sea; yet the sea is not full; unto the place from whence the rivers come, thither they return again.* All the rivers run into the sea, yet the sea is not full. To the place from which the rivers come, there they return again.
- 8 *All things are full of labour; man cannot utter it: the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.* All things are full of labor; a man cannot put it into words. The eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.
- 9 *The thing that hath been, it is that which shall be; and that which is done is that which shall be done: and there is no new thing under the sun.* That which has been is what shall be, and that which is done is what shall be done. There is no new thing under the sun.
- 10 *Is there any thing whereof it may be said, See, this is new? it hath been already of old time, which was before us.* Is there anything of which it may be said, "See, this is new"? It has already been in ancient times, which were before us.
- 11 *There is no remembrance of former things; neither shall there be any remembrance of things that are to come with those that shall come after.* There is no memory of former things, nor will there be any memory of things to come among those who come after.
- 12 *I the Preacher was king over Israel in Jerusalem.* I, the Preacher, was king over Israel in Jerusalem.
- 13 *And I gave my heart to seek and search out by wisdom concerning all things that are done under heaven: this sore travail hath God given to the sons of man to be exercised therewith.* I set my heart to seek and search out by wisdom all things that are done under heaven. This heavy task God has given to the sons of man, to be busy with.
- 14 *I have seen all the works that are done under the sun; and, behold, all is vanity and vexation of spirit.* I have seen all the works that are done under the sun, and all is vanity and vexation of spirit.
- 15 *That which is crooked cannot be made straight: and that which is wanting cannot be numbered.* What is crooked cannot be made straight, and what is lacking cannot be counted.

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| <p>16 <i>I communed with mine own heart, saying, Lo, I am come to great estate, and have gotten more wisdom than all they that have been before me in Jerusalem: yea, my heart had great experience of wisdom and knowledge.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And I gave my heart to know wisdom, and to know madness and folly: I perceived that this also is vexation of spirit.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For in much wisdom is much grief: and he that increaseth knowledge increaseth sorrow.</i></p> | <p>I spoke with my own heart, saying, "I have come to greatness and have gained more wisdom than all who were before me in Jerusalem. My heart has had great experience of wisdom and knowledge."</p> <p>I set my heart to know wisdom, and to know madness and folly. I saw that this also is vexation of spirit.</p> <p>For in much wisdom is much grief, and he who increases knowledge increases sorrow.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eccl 12:8-10; Eccl 1:12; Eccl 7:27
- v2** — Ps 144:4; Rom 8:20; Eccl 5:10; Ps 39:5-6; Eccl 12:8
- v3** — Eccl 3:9; Eccl 2:22; Eccl 5:16; Mark 8:36-37; Eccl 2:11
- v4** — Ps 104:5; Eccl 6:12; Zech 1:5; Matt 24:35
- v8** — Prov 27:20; Matt 11:28
- v9** — Eccl 3:15; Eccl 6:10; Rev 21:1; Eccl 2:12; Eccl 7:10
- v11** — Eccl 2:16; Ps 9:6; Eccl 9:5
- v13** — Eccl 3:10; Gen 3:19; Eccl 8:16-17; Eccl 1:17; 1 Tim 4:15
- v14** — Eccl 2:11; Eccl 2:17; Eccl 2:26; Eccl 6:9
- v15** — Eccl 7:12-13; Matt 6:27; Eccl 3:14
- v16** — Eccl 2:9; 1 Kgs 4:30
- v18** — Job 28:28; Eccl 12:12-13; 1 Cor 3:18-20; Eccl 7:16; Jas 3:13-17

Chapter 2

The Preacher tests himself with pleasure, laughter, wine, great building projects, wealth, and every delight, and concludes that all of it is vanity and vexation of spirit. He observes that the wise man and the fool share the same death, and that the only good is to eat, drink, and find enjoyment in one's labor as a gift from God.

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| <p>1 <i>I said in mine heart, Go to now, I will prove thee with mirth, therefore enjoy pleasure: and, behold, this also is vanity.</i></p> <p>2 <i>I said of laughter, It is mad: and of mirth, What doeth it?</i></p> <p>3 <i>I sought in mine heart to give myself unto wine, yet acquainting mine heart with wisdom; and to lay hold on folly, till I might see what was that good for the sons of men, which they should do under the heaven all the days of their life.</i></p> <p>4 <i>I made me great works; I builded me houses; I planted me vineyards:</i></p> <p>5 <i>I made me gardens and orchards, and I planted trees in them of all kind of fruits:</i></p> <p>6 <i>I made me pools of water, to water therewith the wood that bringeth forth trees:</i></p> <p>7 <i>I got me servants and maidens, and had servants born in my house; also I had great possessions of great and small cattle above all that were in Jerusalem before me:</i></p> <p>8 <i>I gathered me also silver and gold, and the peculiar treasure of kings and of the provinces: I gat me men singers and women singers, and the delights of the sons of men, as musical instruments, and that of all sorts.</i></p> | <p>I said in my heart, "Come now, I will test you with mirth, so enjoy pleasure." But this also was vanity.</p> <p>I said of laughter, "It is mad," and of mirth, "What does it accomplish?"</p> <p>I sought in my heart to give myself to wine, while my heart still guided me with wisdom, and to take hold of folly. I wanted to see what was good for the sons of men to do under heaven all the days of their life.</p> <p>I made great works for myself. I built houses for myself and planted vineyards.</p> <p>I made gardens and orchards for myself, and I planted in them trees of every kind of fruit.</p> <p>I made pools of water for myself, to water the woods that brought forth trees.</p> <p>I obtained menservants and maidservants, and I had servants born in my house. I also had great possessions of herds and flocks, more than all who were in Jerusalem before me.</p> <p>I also gathered for myself silver and gold, and the special treasure of kings and provinces. I obtained men singers and women singers, and the delights of the sons of men, with musical instruments of all kinds.</p> |
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- 9 *So I was great, and increased more than all that were before me in Jerusalem: also my wisdom remained with me.* So I became great, and increased more than all who were before me in Jerusalem. My wisdom also remained with me.
- 10 *And whatsoever mine eyes desired I kept not from them, I withheld not my heart from any joy; for my heart rejoiced in all my labour: and this was my portion of all my labour.* Whatever my eyes desired, I did not keep from them. I withheld my heart from no joy, for my heart rejoiced in all my labor. This was my portion of all my labor.
- 11 *Then I looked on all the works that my hands had wrought, and on the labour that I had laboured to do: and, behold, all was vanity and vexation of spirit, and there was no profit under the sun.* Then I looked on all the works my hands had done, and on the labor I had toiled to do. All was vanity and vexation of spirit, and there was no profit under the sun.
- 12 *And I turned myself to behold wisdom, and madness, and folly: for what can the man do that cometh after the king? even that which hath been already done.* Then I turned myself to consider wisdom, madness, and folly. For what can the man do who comes after the king? Only what has already been done.
- 13 *Then I saw that wisdom excelleth folly, as far as light excelleth darkness.* Then I saw that wisdom excels folly, as far as light excels darkness.
- 14 *The wise man's eyes are in his head; but the fool walketh in darkness: and I myself perceived also that one event happeneth to them all.* The wise man's eyes are in his head, but the fool walks in darkness. Yet I also saw that one event happens to them all.
- 15 *Then said I in my heart, As it happeneth to the fool, so it happeneth even to me; and why was I then more wise? Then I said in my heart, that this also is vanity.* Then I said in my heart, "As it happens to the fool, so it happens even to me. Why then was I more wise?" Then I said in my heart that this also is vanity.

- 16 *For there is no remembrance of the wise more than of the fool for ever; seeing that which now is in the days to come shall all be forgotten. And how dieth the wise man? as the fool.* For there is no lasting memory of the wise more than of the fool, since in the days to come all will be forgotten. And how does the wise man die? Just like the fool.
- 17 *Therefore I hated life; because the work that is wrought under the sun is grievous unto me: for all is vanity and vexation of spirit.* So I hated life, because the work that is done under the sun was grievous to me. For all is vanity and vexation of spirit.
- 18 *Yea, I hated all my labour wherein I had laboured under the sun: seeing that I must leave it unto the man that shall be after me.* I hated all my labor at which I had worked under the sun, seeing that I must leave it to the man who will come after me.
- 19 *And who knoweth whether he shall be a wise man or a fool? yet shall he have rule over all my labour wherein I have laboured, and wherein I have shewed myself wise under the sun. This is also vanity.* And who knows whether he will be a wise man or a fool? Yet he will have rule over all my labor at which I have worked and shown myself wise under the sun. This also is vanity.
- 20 *Therefore I went about to cause my heart to despair of all the labour which I took under the sun.* So I turned to make my heart despair of all the labor at which I had worked under the sun.
- 21 *For there is a man whose labour is in wisdom, and in knowledge, and in equity; yet to a man that hath not laboured therein shall he leave it for his portion. This also is vanity and a great evil.* For there is a man whose labor is done with wisdom, knowledge, and fairness, yet he must leave it as a portion to a man who has not labored in it. This also is vanity and a great evil.
- 22 *For what hath man of all his labour, and of the vexation of his heart, wherein he hath laboured under the sun?* For what does a man have from all his labor and from the vexation of his heart, at which he has labored under the sun?
- 23 *For all his days are sorrows, and his travail grief; yea, his heart taketh not rest in the night. This is also vanity.* For all his days are sorrows, and his work is grief. Even in the night his heart takes no rest. This also is vanity.

24	<i>There is nothing better for a man, than that he should eat and drink, and that he should make his soul enjoy good in his labour. This also I saw, that it was from the hand of God.</i>	There is nothing better for a man than to eat and drink, and to let his soul enjoy good in his labor. This also I saw, that it was from the hand of God.
25	<i>For who can eat, or who else can hasten hereunto, more than I?</i>	For who can eat, or who can enjoy it, more than I?
26	<i>For God giveth to a man that is good in his sight wisdom, and knowledge, and joy: but to the sinner he giveth travail, to gather and to heap up, that he may give to him that is good before God. This also is vanity and vexation of spirit.</i>	For God gives to the man who is good in his sight wisdom, knowledge, and joy. But to the sinner he gives the task of gathering and heaping up, that he may give it to the one who is good before God. This also is vanity and vexation of spirit.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 12:19; Eccl 8:15
- v3 — Prov 20:1; Eccl 1:17
- v8 — 1 Kgs 10:10; 1 Kgs 9:28; 2 Sam 19:35
- v9 — 1 Chr 29:25; Eccl 1:16; 1 Kgs 10:23; 2 Chr 9:22-23
- v10 — Eccl 9:9; Eccl 5:18; Eccl 3:22
- v11 — Eccl 1:14; 1 John 2:16-17; Eccl 1:3
- v12 — Eccl 1:17; Eccl 7:25
- v14 — Ps 49:10; Prov 17:24
- v16 — Eccl 1:11; Eccl 9:5
- v23 — Job 14:1; Job 5:7
- v24 — Eccl 3:22; Eccl 8:15; 1 Tim 6:17; Eccl 5:18-19; Eccl 3:12-13
- v26 — Prov 13:22; Job 27:16-17; Prov 28:8; John 16:24; Isa 3:10-11

Chapter 3

The Preacher declares that there is a time for everything — a time to be born and a time to die, a time to weep and a time to laugh. He observes that God has made everything beautiful in its time and set eternity in the hearts of men, yet no one can find out the full work of God. He notes that man and beast share the same breath and the same death, and all return to dust.

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| 1 | <i>To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven:</i> | To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under heaven: |
| 2 | <i>A time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted;</i> | a time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pull up what is planted; |
| 3 | <i>A time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up;</i> | a time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to tear down, and a time to build up; |
| 4 | <i>A time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance;</i> | a time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance; |
| 5 | <i>A time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing;</i> | a time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing; |
| 6 | <i>A time to get, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away;</i> | a time to gain, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to throw away; |
| 7 | <i>A time to rend, and a time to sew; a time to keep silence, and a time to speak;</i> | a time to tear, and a time to sew; a time to keep silent, and a time to speak; |
| 8 | <i>A time to love, and a time to hate; a time of war, and a time of peace.</i> | a time to love, and a time to hate; a time of war, and a time of peace. |
| 9 | <i>What profit hath he that worketh in that wherein he laboureth?</i> | What profit has the worker from that in which he labors? |
| 10 | <i>I have seen the travail, which God hath given to the sons of man to be exercised in it.</i> | I have seen the task that God has given to the sons of man, to be busy with. |
| 11 | <i>He hath made every thing beautiful in his time: also he hath set the world in their heart, so that no man can find out the work that God maketh from the beginning to the end.</i> | He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set the world in their heart, yet no man can find out the work that God makes from the beginning to the end. |

- 12 *I know that there is no good in them, but to rejoice, and to do good in his life.* I know that there is nothing better for them than to rejoice and to do good in their life.
- 13 *And also that every man should eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labour, it is the gift of God.* And also that every man should eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labor — it is the gift of God.
- 14 *I know that, whatsoever God doeth, it shall be for ever: nothing can be put to it, nor any thing taken from it: and God doeth it, that men should fear before him.* I know that whatever God does, it shall be forever. Nothing can be added to it, nor anything taken from it. God does it so that men should fear before Him.
- 15 *That which hath been is now; and that which is to be hath already been; and God requireth that which is past.* That which has been is now, and that which is to be has already been. And God requires what is past.
- 16 *And moreover I saw under the sun the place of judgment, that wickedness was there; and the place of righteousness, that iniquity was there.* Moreover I saw under the sun the place of judgment, and wickedness was there; and the place of righteousness, and iniquity was there.
- 17 *I said in mine heart, God shall judge the righteous and the wicked: for there is a time there for every purpose and for every work.* I said in my heart, "God shall judge the righteous and the wicked, for there is a time there for every purpose and for every work."
- 18 *I said in mine heart concerning the estate of the sons of men, that God might manifest them, and that they might see that they themselves are beasts.* I said in my heart concerning the state of the sons of men, that God might test them, and that they might see they themselves are like beasts.
- 19 *For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one breath; so that a man hath no preeminence above a beast: for all is vanity.* For what happens to the sons of men also happens to beasts; one thing happens to them both. As one dies, so dies the other. They all have one breath, so that a man has no advantage over a beast, for all is vanity.

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| 20 | <i>All go unto one place; all are of the dust, and all turn to dust again.</i> | All go to one place. All are from the dust, and all turn to dust again. |
| 21 | <i>Who knoweth the spirit of man that goeth upward, and the spirit of the beast that goeth downward to the earth?</i> | Who knows the spirit of man, whether it goes upward, and the spirit of the beast, whether it goes downward to the earth? |
| 22 | <i>Wherefore I perceive that there is nothing better, than that a man should rejoice in his own works; for that is his portion: for who shall bring him to see what shall be after him?</i> | So I saw that there is nothing better than that a man should rejoice in his own works, for that is his portion. For who shall bring him to see what shall be after him? |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eccl 3:17; Matt 16:3; Eccl 8:5-6; Eccl 7:14; 2 Kgs 5:26
- v2 — Heb 9:27; Job 14:5; Matt 15:13; Jer 18:7-10; John 16:21
- v3 — Hos 6:1-2; 1 Sam 2:6; Jer 45:4; Jer 31:28; Deut 32:39
- v4 — Rom 12:15; Ps 30:5; Jas 4:9; Ps 126:5-6; Ps 126:1-2
- v6 — Phil 3:7-8; Luke 9:24-25; Mark 8:35-37; Matt 16:25-26; Ps 112:9
- v7 — Amos 5:13; Mic 7:5; Esth 4:13-14; Lam 3:28; Prov 31:8-9
- v8 — Eph 5:25; Eph 5:28-29; Luke 14:26; 1 Kgs 5:4; Ps 139:21
- v11 — Rom 1:19-20; Rom 11:33; Job 11:7; Eccl 8:17; Job 5:9
- v13 — Isa 65:21-23; Eccl 2:24; Eccl 9:7; Ps 128:2
- v14 — Jas 1:17; Ps 33:11; Rom 11:36; Acts 5:39; Prov 30:6
- v18 — Ps 73:22; Ps 49:12; Gen 3:17-19; 2 Pet 2:12; Heb 9:27
- v22 — Eccl 2:24; Eccl 3:11-12; Eccl 6:12; Eccl 8:7; Eccl 10:14

Chapter 4

The Preacher considers the oppressions done under the sun and sees that the oppressed have no comforter. He observes that all labor and skillful work spring from envy, that two are better than one, and that a threefold cord is not quickly broken. He notes that even a poor wise child is better than an old foolish king.

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| 1 <i>So I returned, and considered all the oppressions that are done under the sun: and behold the tears of such as were oppressed, and they had no comforter; and on the side of their oppressors there was power; but they had no comforter.</i> | So I returned and considered all the oppressions that are done under the sun. I saw the tears of those who were oppressed, and they had no comforter. On the side of their oppressors there was power, but they had no comforter. |
| 2 <i>Wherefore I praised the dead which are already dead more than the living which are yet alive.</i> | Therefore I praised the dead who were already dead more than the living who are still alive. |
| 3 <i>Yea, better is he than both they, which hath not yet been, who hath not seen the evil work that is done under the sun.</i> | And better than them both is he who has not yet been, who has not seen the evil work that is done under the sun. |
| 4 <i>Again, I considered all travail, and every right work, that for this a man is envied of his neighbour. This is also vanity and vexation of spirit.</i> | Again I considered all labor and every skillful work, and saw that for this a man is envied by his neighbor. This also is vanity and vexation of spirit. |
| 5 <i>The fool foldeth his hands together, and eateth his own flesh.</i> | The fool folds his hands together and eats his own flesh. |
| 6 <i>Better is an handful with quietness, than both the hands full with travail and vexation of spirit.</i> | Better is a handful with quietness than both hands full with labor and vexation of spirit. |
| 7 <i>Then I returned, and I saw vanity under the sun.</i> | Then I returned and saw vanity under the sun. |
| 8 <i>There is one alone, and there is not a second; yea, he hath neither child nor brother: yet is there no end of all his labour; neither is his eye satisfied with riches; neither saith he, For whom do I labour, and bereave my soul of good? This is also vanity, yea, it is a sore travail.</i> | There is one alone, without a second; he has neither child nor brother. Yet there is no end to all his labor, nor is his eye satisfied with riches. Nor does he ask, "For whom do I labor, and deprive my soul of good?" This also is vanity; it is a heavy task. |

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| <p>9 <i>Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow: but woe to him that is alone when he falleth; for he hath not another to help him up.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Again, if two lie together, then they have heat: but how can one be warm alone?</i></p> <p>12 <i>And if one prevail against him, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Better is a poor and a wise child than an old and foolish king, who will no more be admonished.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For out of prison he cometh to reign; whereas also he that is born in his kingdom becometh poor.</i></p> <p>15 <i>I considered all the living which walk under the sun, with the second child that shall stand up in his stead.</i></p> <p>16 <i>There is no end of all the people, even of all that have been before them: they also that come after shall not rejoice in him. Surely this also is vanity and vexation of spirit.</i></p> | <p>Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their labor.</p> <p>For if they fall, the one will lift up his companion. But woe to him who is alone when he falls, for he has no one to help him up.</p> <p>Again, if two lie together, they have warmth. But how can one be warm alone?</p> <p>And if one prevails against him, two shall withstand him. A threefold cord is not quickly broken.</p> <p>Better is a poor and wise child than an old and foolish king who will no longer take warning.</p> <p>For out of prison he comes to reign, while he who is born in his kingdom becomes poor.</p> <p>I considered all the living who walk under the sun, along with the second child who shall stand up in his place.</p> <p>There is no end of all the people, of all who were before them. Yet those who come after shall not rejoice in him. Surely this also is vanity and vexation of spirit.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eccl 3:16; Eccl 5:8; Isa 5:7; Ps 42:3; Lam 1:9
- v2 — Job 3:11-26
- v4 — 1 John 3:12; Eccl 1:14; Eccl 2:21; Eccl 2:26
- v5 — Prov 6:10-11; Isa 9:20
- v6 — Prov 16:8; Prov 15:16-17; Ps 37:16; Prov 17:1
- v8 — 1 John 2:16; Prov 27:20; Luke 12:20; Eccl 1:8; Matt 11:28

v9 — Prov 27:17; Gen 2:18; 1 Cor 12:18-21; Num 11:14; Mark 6:7

v10 — 1 Thess 5:11; 1 Thess 4:18; Gal 6:1; Isa 35:3-4

v11 — 1 Kgs 1:1-4

v12 — Dan 3:16-17; Eph 4:3

v13 — 2 Chr 25:16; Prov 19:1

v14 — Ps 113:7-8; Gen 41:14; Lam 4:20; Job 5:11; 2 Kgs 25:27-30

Chapter 5

The Preacher warns against rash words before God and urges that vows be paid promptly. He observes that the lover of money is never satisfied, that riches kept bring harm to their owner, and that a man leaves the world as naked as he entered it. He concludes that it is good and fitting to eat, drink, and enjoy one's labor, for this is God's gift.

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| 1 <i>Keep thy foot when thou goest to the house of God, and be more ready to hear, than to give the sacrifice of fools: for they consider not that they do evil.</i> | Guard your steps when you go to the house of God. Be more ready to hear than to offer the sacrifice of fools, for they do not consider that they do evil. |
| 2 <i>Be not rash with thy mouth, and let not thine heart be hasty to utter any thing before God: for God is in heaven, and thou upon earth: therefore let thy words be few.</i> | Do not be rash with your mouth, and let not your heart be quick to utter anything before God. For God is in heaven and you on earth, therefore let your words be few. |
| 3 <i>For a dream cometh through the multitude of business; and a fool's voice is known by multitude of words.</i> | For a dream comes through much business, and a fool's voice is known by many words. |
| 4 <i>When thou vowest a vow unto God, defer not to pay it; for he hath no pleasure in fools: pay that which thou hast vowed.</i> | When you vow a vow to God, do not delay to pay it, for He has no pleasure in fools. Pay what you have vowed. |
| 5 <i>Better is it that thou shouldest not vow, than that thou shouldest vow and not pay.</i> | It is better not to vow than to vow and not pay. |

- 6 *Suffer not thy mouth to cause thy flesh to sin; neither say thou before the angel, that it was an error: wherefore should God be angry at thy voice, and destroy the work of thine hands?* Do not let your mouth cause your flesh to sin, and do not say before the angel that it was an error. Why should God be angry at your voice, and destroy the work of your hands?
- 7 *For in the multitude of dreams and many words there are also divers vanities: but fear thou God.* For in the multitude of dreams and many words there are also various vanities. But fear God.
- 8 *If thou seest the oppression of the poor, and violent perverting of judgment and justice in a province, marvel not at the matter: for he that is higher than the highest regardeth; and there be higher than they.* If you see the oppression of the poor, and the violent perversion of judgment and justice in a province, do not marvel at the matter. For he who is higher than the highest regards it, and there are higher ones over them.
- 9 *Moreover the profit of the earth is for all: the king himself is served by the field.* Moreover the profit of the earth is for all. The king himself is served by the field.
- 10 *He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance with increase: this is also vanity.* He who loves silver shall not be satisfied with silver, nor he who loves abundance with increase. This also is vanity.
- 11 *When goods increase, they are increased that eat them: and what good is there to the owners thereof, saving the beholding of them with their eyes?* When goods increase, those who eat them increase. And what good is there for the owners, except to see them with their eyes?
- 12 *The sleep of a labouring man is sweet, whether he eat little or much: but the abundance of the rich will not suffer him to sleep.* The sleep of a working man is sweet, whether he eats little or much. But the abundance of the rich will not let him sleep.
- 13 *There is a sore evil which I have seen under the sun, namely, riches kept for the owners thereof to their hurt.* There is a grievous evil that I have seen under the sun: riches kept for their owners to their own hurt.

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| <p>14 <i>But those riches perish by evil travail: and he begetteth a son, and there is nothing in his hand.</i></p> <p>15 <i>As he came forth of his mother's womb, naked shall he return to go as he came, and shall take nothing of his labour, which he may carry away in his hand.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And this also is a sore evil, that in all points as he came, so shall he go: and what profit hath he that hath laboured for the wind?</i></p> <p>17 <i>All his days also he eateth in darkness, and he hath much sorrow and wrath with his sickness.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Behold that which I have seen: it is good and comely for one to eat and to drink, and to enjoy the good of all his labour that he taketh under the sun all the days of his life, which God giveth him: for it is his portion.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Every man also to whom God hath given riches and wealth, and hath given him power to eat thereof, and to take his portion, and to rejoice in his labour; this is the gift of God.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For he shall not much remember the days of his life; because God answereth him in the joy of his heart.</i></p> | <p>But those riches perish through misfortune, and he fathers a son, and there is nothing in his hand.</p> <p>As he came forth from his mother's womb, naked shall he return, going as he came. He shall take nothing from his labor that he can carry away in his hand.</p> <p>And this also is a grievous evil: in every way as he came, so shall he go. And what profit has he who has labored for the wind?</p> <p>All his days he also eats in darkness, and he has much sorrow, sickness, and wrath.</p> <p>This is what I have seen: it is good and fitting for one to eat and drink, and to enjoy the good of all his labor at which he works under the sun all the days of his life that God gives Him. For this is His portion.</p> <p>And every man to whom God has given riches and wealth, and given Him power to eat from them, to take His portion and to rejoice in His labor — this is the gift of God.</p> <p>For he shall not much remember the days of his life, because God keeps Him busy with the joy of His heart.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jas 1:19; Heb 12:28-29; Prov 15:8; 1 Pet 2:1-2; Isa 1:12-20
v2 — Matt 6:7; Prov 10:19; Isa 55:9; Matt 6:9; Gen 18:27
v4 — Num 30:2; Ps 76:11; Deut 23:21-23; Matt 5:33; Ps 66:13-14

- v5 — Acts 5:4; Deut 23:22; Prov 20:25
 v6 — Jas 1:26; 2 John 1:8; Jas 3:2; Mal 2:7; Eccl 5:1-2
 v7 — Matt 12:36; Eccl 12:13; Eccl 8:12; Eccl 5:3; Prov 23:17
 v10 — 1 Tim 6:10; Matt 6:24; Luke 12:15; Matt 6:19; Eccl 4:8
 v13 — Eccl 6:1-2; Luke 18:22-23; Luke 16:22-23; Gen 19:14; Jas 5:1-4
 v15 — Job 1:21; Ps 49:17; 1 Tim 6:7; Luke 12:20
 v18 — Eccl 2:24; Eccl 3:12-13; Eccl 3:22; Eccl 9:7; 1 Tim 6:17
 v19 — Deut 8:18; Eccl 3:13; Eccl 6:2; 2 Chr 1:12; Eccl 2:24-26
 v20 — Isa 65:21-24; Isa 65:13-14; Ps 37:16; Rom 5:1; Ps 4:6-7

Chapter 6

The Preacher describes the evil of a man to whom God gives wealth, honor, and everything he desires, yet God does not give him the power to enjoy it. He argues that a stillborn child is better off than such a man, and that no one knows what is good for man in the days of his vain life.

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| 1 | <i>There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, and it is common among men:</i> | There is an evil that I have seen under the sun, and it is common among men: |
| 2 | <i>A man to whom God hath given riches, wealth, and honour, so that he wanteth nothing for his soul of all that he desireth, yet God giveth him not power to eat thereof, but a stranger eateth it: this is vanity, and it is an evil disease.</i> | A man to whom God has given riches, wealth, and honor, so that He lacks nothing for His soul of all that He desires, yet God does not give Him the power to enjoy them, but a stranger eats them. This is vanity, and it is an evil disease. |
| 3 | <i>If a man beget an hundred children, and live many years, so that the days of his years be many, and his soul be not filled with good, and also that he have no burial; I say, that an untimely birth is better than he.</i> | If a man fathers a hundred children and lives many years, so that the days of his years are many, but his soul is not filled with good, and he has no burial — I say that a stillborn child is better than he. |
| 4 | <i>For he cometh in with vanity, and departeth in darkness, and his name shall be covered with darkness.</i> | For it comes in with vanity and departs in darkness, and its name is covered with darkness. |
| 5 | <i>Moreover he hath not seen the sun, nor known any thing: this hath more rest than the other.</i> | Moreover it has not seen the sun, nor known anything. This has more rest than the other. |

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| <p>6 <i>Yea, though he live a thousand years twice told, yet hath he seen no good: do not all go to one place?</i></p> <p>7 <i>All the labour of man is for his mouth, and yet the appetite is not filled.</i></p> <p>8 <i>For what hath the wise more than the fool? what hath the poor, that knoweth to walk before the living?</i></p> <p>9 <i>Better is the sight of the eyes than the wandering of the desire: this is also vanity and vexation of spirit.</i></p> <p>10 <i>That which hath been is named already, and it is known that it is man: neither can he contend with him that is mightier than he.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Seeing there be many things that increase vanity, what is man the better?</i></p> <p>12 <i>For who knoweth what is good for man in this life, all the days of his vain life which he spendeth as a shadow? for who can tell a man what shall be after him under the sun?</i></p> | <p>Indeed, though he lives a thousand years twice over, yet he has seen no good. Do not all go to one place?</p> <p>All the labor of man is for his mouth, and yet his appetite is not filled.</p> <p>For what does the wise have more than the fool? What does the poor man have, who knows how to walk before the living?</p> <p>Better is the sight of the eyes than the wandering of desire. This also is vanity and vexation of spirit.</p> <p>That which has been is named already, and it is known that it is man. He cannot contend with him who is mightier than he.</p> <p>Since there are many things that increase vanity, what is man the better for it?</p> <p>For who knows what is good for man in this life, all the days of his vain life which he spends like a shadow? Who can tell a man what shall be after him under the sun?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eccl 5:13
- v2 — Eccl 5:19; Ps 17:14; Ps 73:7; Lam 5:2; 1 Kgs 3:13
- v3 — Job 3:16
- v7 — John 6:27; Prov 16:26; 1 Tim 6:6-8; Matt 6:25; Eccl 5:10
- v8 — Prov 19:1
- v9 — Eccl 1:14
- v10 — Job 9:32; Isa 45:9-10; Job 40:2
- v12 — Jas 4:14; Job 14:2; Eccl 3:22; Lam 3:24-27; Ps 144:4

Chapter 7

The Preacher offers proverbs on wisdom: a good name is better than precious ointment, sorrow is better than laughter, and the patient in spirit is better than the proud. He warns against being overly righteous or overly wicked and observes that there is not a just man on earth who does good and does not sin. He concludes that God made man upright, but men have sought out many inventions.

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| 1 | <i>A good name is better than precious ointment; and the day of death than the day of one's birth.</i> | A good name is better than precious ointment, and the day of death than the day of one's birth. |
| 2 | <i>It is better to go to the house of mourning, than to go to the house of feasting: for that is the end of all men; and the living will lay it to his heart.</i> | It is better to go to the house of mourning than to go to the house of feasting, for that is the end of all men, and the living will lay it to his heart. |
| 3 | <i>Sorrow is better than laughter: for by the sadness of the countenance the heart is made better.</i> | Sorrow is better than laughter, for by the sadness of the countenance the heart is made better. |
| 4 | <i>The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth.</i> | The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning, but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth. |
| 5 | <i>It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise, than for a man to hear the song of fools.</i> | It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise than for a man to hear the song of fools. |
| 6 | <i>For as the crackling of thorns under a pot, so is the laughter of the fool: this also is vanity.</i> | For as the crackling of thorns under a pot, so is the laughter of the fool. This also is vanity. |
| 7 | <i>Surely oppression maketh a wise man mad; and a gift destroyeth the heart.</i> | Surely oppression drives a wise man mad, and a bribe destroys the heart. |
| 8 | <i>Better is the end of a thing than the beginning thereof: and the patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit.</i> | Better is the end of a thing than its beginning, and the patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit. |
| 9 | <i>Be not hasty in thy spirit to be angry: for anger resteth in the bosom of fools.</i> | Do not be hasty in your spirit to be angry, for anger rests in the bosom of fools. |

- 10 *Say not thou, What is the cause that the former days were better than these? for thou dost not enquire wisely concerning this.* Do not say, "What is the cause that the former days were better than these?" For you do not inquire wisely about this.
- 11 *Wisdom is good with an inheritance: and by it there is profit to them that see the sun.* Wisdom is good with an inheritance, and by it there is profit to those who see the sun.
- 12 *For wisdom is a defence, and money is a defence: but the excellency of knowledge is, that wisdom giveth life to them that have it.* For wisdom is a defense, and money is a defense; but the excellence of knowledge is that wisdom gives life to those who have it.
- 13 *Consider the work of God: for who can make that straight, which he hath made crooked?* Consider the work of God, for who can make straight what He has made crooked?
- 14 *In the day of prosperity be joyful, but in the day of adversity consider: God also hath set the one over against the other, to the end that man should find nothing after him.* In the day of prosperity be joyful, but in the day of adversity consider: God has set the one over against the other, so that man should find nothing of what shall be after Him.
- 15 *All things have I seen in the days of my vanity: there is a just man that perisheth in his righteousness, and there is a wicked man that longeth his life in his wickedness.* All things I have seen in the days of my vanity: there is a just man who perishes in his righteousness, and there is a wicked man who prolongs his life in his wickedness.
- 16 *Be not righteous over much; neither make thyself over wise: why shouldst thou destroy thyself?* Do not be overly righteous, nor make yourself overly wise. Why should you destroy yourself?
- 17 *Be not over much wicked, neither be thou foolish: why shouldst thou die before thy time?* Do not be overly wicked, nor be a fool. Why should you die before your time?

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| 18 <i>It is good that thou shouldest take hold of this; yea, also from this withdraw not thine hand: for he that feareth God shall come forth of them all.</i> | It is good that you should take hold of this, and also from the other do not withdraw your hand. For he who fears God shall come forth from them all. |
| 19 <i>Wisdom strengtheneth the wise more than ten mighty men which are in the city.</i> | Wisdom strengthens the wise more than ten mighty men who are in the city. |
| 20 <i>For there is not a just man upon earth, that doeth good, and sinneth not.</i> | For there is not a just man on earth who does good and does not sin. |
| 21 <i>Also take no heed unto all words that are spoken; lest thou hear thy servant curse thee:</i> | Also do not take to heart every word that is spoken, lest you hear your servant curse you. |
| 22 <i>For oftentimes also thine own heart knoweth that thou thyself likewise hast cursed others.</i> | For often your own heart knows that you yourself have likewise cursed others. |
| 23 <i>All this have I proved by wisdom: I said, I will be wise; but it was far from me.</i> | All this I have proved by wisdom. I said, "I will be wise," but it was far from me. |
| 24 <i>That which is far off, and exceeding deep, who can find it out?</i> | That which is far off and exceedingly deep — who can find it out? |
| 25 <i>I applied mine heart to know, and to search, and to seek out wisdom, and the reason of things, and to know the wickedness of folly, even of foolishness and madness:</i> | I applied my heart to know, and to search, and to seek out wisdom and the reason of things, and to know the wickedness of folly, even of foolishness and madness. |
| 26 <i>And I find more bitter than death the woman, whose heart is snares and nets, and her hands as bands: whoso pleaseth God shall escape from her; but the sinner shall be taken by her.</i> | And I find more bitter than death the woman whose heart is snares and nets, and her hands are like bands. Whoever pleases God shall escape from her, but the sinner shall be taken by her. |

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| 27 | <i>Behold, this have I found, saith the Preacher, counting one by one, to find out the account:</i> | "See, this I have found," says the Preacher, "counting one by one to find out the account, |
| 28 | <i>Which yet my soul seeketh, but I find not: one man among a thousand have I found; but a woman among all those have I not found.</i> | which my soul still seeks, but I have not found. One man among a thousand I have found, but a woman among all those I have not found. |
| 29 | <i>Lo, this only have I found, that God hath made man upright; but they have sought out many inventions.</i> | This only I have found: that God has made man upright, but they have sought out many inventions." |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 14:13; Prov 22:1; Eccl 4:2; 2 Cor 5:8; Phil 1:21-23
v3 — 2 Cor 7:9-11; Rom 5:3-4; Jas 4:8-10; 2 Cor 4:17; Heb 12:10-11
v7 — Deut 16:19; Ex 23:8; Prov 17:23; Prov 17:8; Eccl 4:1
v8 — Heb 10:36; Ps 126:5-6; Prov 14:29; 1 Pet 1:13; Jas 5:11
v9 — Jas 1:19; Prov 14:17; Eph 4:26-27; Prov 16:32; Prov 26:23-26
v13 — Eccl 1:15; Job 12:14; Ps 107:43; Eccl 3:11; Isa 5:12
v14 — Eccl 3:4; Eccl 3:22; Eccl 12:13; Deut 8:3; Jas 5:13
v16 — Rom 12:3; Prov 25:16; Col 2:18; Matt 6:1-7; Jas 3:13-17
v17 — Prov 10:27; Ps 55:23; Job 22:16; Acts 12:23; Acts 5:5
v20 — Rom 3:23; Isa 53:6; 1 John 1:8-10; Jas 3:2; 1 Kgs 8:46
v26 — Prov 22:14; Prov 5:3-5; Prov 2:16; Eccl 2:26; Prov 2:18-19
v29 — Jer 4:22; Gen 6:11-12; Mark 7:8-9; Gen 5:1; Titus 3:3

Chapter 8

The Preacher counsels obedience to the king and observes that no man has power over the day of death. He notes that because sentence against evil is not carried out quickly, men are emboldened to sin, yet he knows it shall be well with those who fear God. He concludes that no man can find out all the work of God, no matter how hard he searches.

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| 1 | <i>Who is as the wise man? and who knoweth the interpretation of a thing? a man's wisdom maketh his face to shine, and the boldness of his face shall be changed.</i> | Who is like the wise man? And who knows the interpretation of a thing? A man's wisdom makes his face shine, and the hardness of his face is changed. |
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| 2 | <i>I counsel thee to keep the king's commandment, and that in regard of the oath of God.</i> | I counsel you to keep the king's commandment, because of the oath of God. |
| 3 | <i>Be not hasty to go out of his sight: stand not in an evil thing; for he doeth whatsoever pleaseth him.</i> | Do not be hasty to go out of his presence. Do not persist in an evil thing, for he does whatever pleases him. |
| 4 | <i>Where the word of a king is, there is power: and who may say unto him, What doest thou?</i> | Where the word of a king is, there is power, and who may say to him, "What are you doing?" |
| 5 | <i>Whoso keepeth the commandment shall feel no evil thing: and a wise man's heart discerneth both time and judgment.</i> | Whoever keeps the commandment shall feel no evil thing, and a wise man's heart discerns both time and judgment. |
| 6 | <i>Because to every purpose there is time and judgment, therefore the misery of man is great upon him.</i> | Because for every purpose there is time and judgment, therefore the misery of man is great upon him. |
| 7 | <i>For he knoweth not that which shall be: for who can tell him when it shall be?</i> | For he does not know what shall be, for who can tell him when it shall be? |
| 8 | <i>There is no man that hath power over the spirit to retain the spirit; neither hath he power in the day of death: and there is no discharge in that war; neither shall wickedness deliver those that are given to it.</i> | No man has power over the spirit to retain the spirit, nor has He power in the day of death. There is no discharge in that war, nor shall wickedness deliver those who are given to it. |
| 9 | <i>All this have I seen, and applied my heart unto every work that is done under the sun: there is a time wherein one man ruleth over another to his own hurt.</i> | All this I have seen, and applied my heart to every work that is done under the sun. There is a time when one man rules over another to his own hurt. |

- 10 *And so I saw the wicked buried, who had come and gone from the place of the holy, and they were forgotten in the city where they had so done: this is also vanity.* And so I saw the wicked buried, who had come and gone from the place of the holy, and they were forgotten in the city where they had done so. This also is vanity.
- 11 *Because sentence against an evil work is not executed speedily, therefore the heart of the sons of men is fully set in them to do evil.* Because sentence against an evil work is not carried out speedily, therefore the heart of the sons of men is fully set in them to do evil.
- 12 *Though a sinner do evil an hundred times, and his days be prolonged, yet surely I know that it shall be well with them that fear God, which fear before him:* Though a sinner does evil a hundred times and his days are prolonged, yet surely I know that it shall be well with those who fear God, Who fear before Him.
- 13 *But it shall not be well with the wicked, neither shall he prolong his days, which are as a shadow; because he feareth not before God.* But it shall not be well with the wicked, nor shall he prolong his days, which are as a shadow, because he does not fear before God.
- 14 *There is a vanity which is done upon the earth; that there be just men, unto whom it happeneth according to the work of the wicked; again, there be wicked men, to whom it happeneth according to the work of the righteous: I said that this also is vanity.* There is a vanity that is done on the earth: there are just men to whom it happens according to the work of the wicked; again, there are wicked men to whom it happens according to the work of the righteous. I said that this also is vanity.
- 15 *Then I commended mirth, because a man hath no better thing under the sun, than to eat, and to drink, and to be merry: for that shall abide with him of his labour the days of his life, which God giveth him under the sun.* Then I commended mirth, because a man has no better thing under the sun than to eat and to drink and to be merry. For this shall remain with him from his labor the days of his life, which God gives Him under the sun.

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| <p>16 <i>When I applied mine heart to know wisdom, and to see the business that is done upon earth: (for also there is that neither day nor night seeth sleep with his eyes:)</i></p> <p>17 <i>Then I beheld all the work of God, that man cannot find out the work that is done under the sun: because though a man labour to seek it out, yea further; though a wise man think to know it, yet shall he not be able to find it.</i></p> | <p>When I applied my heart to know wisdom and to see the business that is done on the earth — for there is one who neither day nor night sees sleep with his eyes —</p> <p>then I saw all the work of God, that man cannot find out the work that is done under the sun. Though a man labors to seek it out, yet he shall not find it. And though a wise man thinks to know it, yet He shall not be able to find it.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 6:15; Deut 28:50
- v2 — Prov 24:21; Titus 3:1
- v3 — Eccl 10:4
- v4 — Rom 13:1-4; Job 9:12
- v5 — Heb 5:14; Phil 1:9-10; 1 Pet 3:13-14
- v6 — Eccl 3:1; Eccl 3:17
- v8 — Ps 89:48; Job 14:5; Ps 49:6-9; Heb 9:27; Eccl 3:21
- v11 — Isa 26:10; Ps 50:21-22; Rom 2:4-5; 2 Pet 3:3-10; Matt 24:49-50
- v12 — Ps 37:11; Luke 1:50; 2 Pet 2:9; Eccl 7:15; Ps 37:18-19
- v14 — Eccl 7:15; Mal 3:15; Eccl 2:14
- v15 — Eccl 2:24; Eccl 5:18; Eccl 3:12-13
- v17 — Eccl 3:11; Ps 73:16; Rom 11:33

Chapter 9

The Preacher observes that one event — death — happens to all alike, to the righteous and the wicked. He urges men to eat, drink, and enjoy life with the wife they love, for there is no work or wisdom in the grave. He notes that the race is not to the swift nor the battle to the strong, and that wisdom, though better than weapons of war, is often despised.

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| 1 | <i>For all this I considered in my heart even to declare all this, that the righteous, and the wise, and their works, are in the hand of God: no man knoweth either love or hatred by all that is before them.</i> | For all this I considered in my heart, to declare all this: that the righteous and the wise, and their works, are in the hand of God. No man knows either love or hatred by all that is before them. |
| 2 | <i>All things come alike to all: there is one event to the righteous, and to the wicked; to the good and to the clean, and to the unclean; to him that sacrificeth, and to him that sacrificeth not: as is the good, so is the sinner; and he that sweareth, as he that feareth an oath.</i> | All things come alike to all: one event happens to the righteous and to the wicked, to the good and to the clean and to the unclean, to him who sacrifices and to him who does not sacrifice. As is the good, so is the sinner; and he who swears, so is he who fears an oath. |
| 3 | <i>This is an evil among all things that are done under the sun, that there is one event unto all: yea, also the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and madness is in their heart while they live, and after that they go to the dead.</i> | This is an evil among all things that are done under the sun: that one event happens to all. Indeed, the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and madness is in their heart while they live, and after that they go to the dead. |
| 4 | <i>For to him that is joined to all the living there is hope: for a living dog is better than a dead lion.</i> | For to him who is joined to all the living there is hope, for a living dog is better than a dead lion. |
| 5 | <i>For the living know that they shall die: but the dead know not any thing, neither have they any more a reward; for the memory of them is forgotten.</i> | For the living know that they shall die, but the dead know nothing. They have no more a reward, for the memory of them is forgotten. |
| 6 | <i>Also their love, and their hatred, and their envy, is now perished; neither have they any more a portion for ever in any thing that is done under the sun.</i> | Also their love, their hatred, and their envy have now perished. Nor have they any more a portion forever in anything that is done under the sun. |

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| 7 | <i>Go thy way, eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart; for God now accepteth thy works.</i> | Go your way, eat your bread with joy, and drink your wine with a merry heart, for God now accepts your works. |
| 8 | <i>Let thy garments be always white; and let thy head lack no ointment.</i> | Let your garments always be white, and let your head lack no ointment. |
| 9 | <i>Live joyfully with the wife whom thou lovest all the days of the life of thy vanity, which he hath given thee under the sun, all the days of thy vanity: for that is thy portion in this life, and in thy labour which thou takest under the sun.</i> | Live joyfully with the wife whom you love all the days of the life of your vanity, which he has given you under the sun, all the days of your vanity. For that is your portion in this life, and in your labor at which you work under the sun. |
| 10 | <i>Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might; for there is no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in the grave, whither thou goest.</i> | Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might, for there is no work, nor planning, nor knowledge, nor wisdom in the grave, where you are going. |
| 11 | <i>I returned, and saw under the sun, that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favour to men of skill; but time and chance happeneth to them all.</i> | I returned and saw under the sun that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, nor bread to the wise, nor riches to men of understanding, nor favor to men of skill; but time and chance happen to them all. |
| 12 | <i>For man also knoweth not his time: as the fishes that are taken in an evil net, and as the birds that are caught in the snare; so are the sons of men snared in an evil time, when it falleth suddenly upon them.</i> | For man also does not know his time. Like the fish that are taken in a cruel net, and like the birds that are caught in the snare, so are the sons of men snared in an evil time when it falls suddenly upon them. |
| 13 | <i>This wisdom have I seen also under the sun, and it seemed great unto me:</i> | This wisdom I have also seen under the sun, and it seemed great to me: |

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| <p>14 <i>There was a little city, and few men within it; and there came a great king against it, and besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it:</i></p> <p>15 <i>Now there was found in it a poor wise man, and he by his wisdom delivered the city; yet no man remembered that same poor man.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Then said I, Wisdom is better than strength: nevertheless the poor man's wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.</i></p> <p>17 <i>The words of wise men are heard in quiet more than the cry of him that ruleth among fools.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Wisdom is better than weapons of war: but one sinner destroyeth much good.</i></p> | <p>There was a little city, and few men within it. A great king came against it, besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it.</p> <p>Now there was found in it a poor wise man, and he by his wisdom delivered the city. Yet no man remembered that same poor man.</p> <p>Then I said, "Wisdom is better than strength." Nevertheless the poor man's wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.</p> <p>The words of wise men are heard in quiet more than the cry of him who rules among fools.</p> <p>Wisdom is better than weapons of war, but one sinner destroys much good.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Mal 3:18; Eccl 2:14-16; Job 9:22; Ps 73:3; Mal 3:5
- v3 — Jer 17:9; Eccl 8:11
- v4 — Job 14:7-12; Isa 38:18; Luke 16:26-29; Lam 3:21-22
- v5 — Isa 26:14; Eccl 1:11; Ps 6:5; Ps 88:10-12; Heb 9:27
- v7 — Eccl 3:12-13; Deut 12:7; Eccl 10:19; Eccl 8:15; Eccl 2:24-26
- v8 — Rev 19:14; Rev 3:4-5; Rev 19:8; Rev 7:13-14; Rev 7:9
- v9 — Prov 5:18-19; Eccl 2:10; Eccl 6:12; Mal 2:15; Eccl 3:13
- v10 — Col 3:23; Eph 5:16; Rom 12:11; Ps 6:5; Eccl 11:6
- v11 — Jer 9:23; Prov 21:30-31; Job 5:11-14; Lam 3:37-38; Eccl 3:17
- v12 — 1 Thess 5:3; Luke 21:34-36; Eccl 8:5-7; Prov 6:15; Prov 29:6
- v15 — Eccl 4:13; Gen 40:23; Esth 6:2-3
- v16 — Eccl 7:19; Prov 24:5; Prov 21:22; Mark 6:2-3; 1 Cor 1:26-29

Chapter 10

The Preacher teaches that a little folly ruins a reputation for wisdom, just as dead flies spoil the ointment. He offers proverbs on rulers and fools: woe to the land whose king is a child, and blessed is the land whose king is the son of nobles. He warns that even a secret curse against the king may be carried by a bird of the air.

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| 1 | <i>Dead flies cause the ointment of the apothecary to send forth a stinking savour: so doth a little folly him that is in reputation for wisdom and honour.</i> | Dead flies cause the ointment of the apothecary to send forth a stinking smell. So does a little folly to him who has a reputation for wisdom and honor. |
| 2 | <i>A wise man's heart is at his right hand; but a fool's heart at his left.</i> | A wise man's heart is at his right hand, but a fool's heart at his left. |
| 3 | <i>Yea also, when he that is a fool walketh by the way, his wisdom faileth him, and he saith to every one that he is a fool.</i> | And also, when he who is a fool walks by the way, his wisdom fails him, and he tells everyone that he is a fool. |
| 4 | <i>If the spirit of the ruler rise up against thee, leave not thy place; for yielding pacifieth great offences.</i> | If the spirit of the ruler rises against you, do not leave your place, for yielding pacifies great offenses. |
| 5 | <i>There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, as an error which proceedeth from the ruler:</i> | There is an evil that I have seen under the sun, like an error that proceeds from the ruler: |
| 6 | <i>Folly is set in great dignity, and the rich sit in low place.</i> | Folly is set in great dignity, and the rich sit in a low place. |
| 7 | <i>I have seen servants upon horses, and princes walking as servants upon the earth.</i> | I have seen servants on horses, and princes walking like servants on the earth. |
| 8 | <i>He that diggeth a pit shall fall into it; and whoso breaketh an hedge, a serpent shall bite him.</i> | He who digs a pit shall fall into it, and whoever breaks through a hedge, a serpent shall bite him. |
| 9 | <i>Whoso removeth stones shall be hurt therewith; and he that cleaveth wood shall be endangered thereby.</i> | Whoever moves stones shall be hurt by them, and he who splits wood shall be endangered by it. |

- 10 *If the iron be blunt, and he do not whet the edge, then must he put to more strength: but wisdom is profitable to direct.* If the iron is blunt, and he does not sharpen the edge, then he must use more strength. But wisdom is profitable to direct.
- 11 *Surely the serpent will bite without enchantment; and a babbler is no better.* Surely the serpent will bite without enchantment, and a babbler is no better.
- 12 *The words of a wise man's mouth are gracious; but the lips of a fool will swallow up himself.* The words of a wise man's mouth are gracious, but the lips of a fool swallow up himself.
- 13 *The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness: and the end of his talk is mischievous madness.* The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness, and the end of his talk is mischievous madness.
- 14 *A fool also is full of words: a man cannot tell what shall be; and what shall be after him, who can tell him?* A fool also is full of words. A man cannot tell what shall be, and what shall be after him, who can tell him?
- 15 *The labour of the foolish wearith every one of them, because he knoweth not how to go to the city.* The labor of fools wearies every one of them, because none of them knows how to go to the city.
- 16 *Woe to thee, O land, when thy king is a child, and thy princes eat in the morning!* Woe to you, O land, when your king is a child, and your princes feast in the morning!
- 17 *Blessed art thou, O land, when thy king is the son of nobles, and thy princes eat in due season, for strength, and not for drunkenness!* Blessed are you, O land, when your king is the son of nobles, and your princes eat at the proper time, for strength and not for drunkenness!
- 18 *By much slothfulness the building decayeth; and through idleness of the hands the house droppeth through.* By much laziness the building decays, and through idleness of the hands the house leaks.
- 19 *A feast is made for laughter, and wine maketh merry: but money answereth all things.* A feast is made for laughter, and wine makes merry, but money answers all things.

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| 20 <i>Curse not the king, no not in thy thought; and curse not the rich in thy bedchamber: for a bird of the air shall carry the voice, and that which hath wings shall tell the matter.</i> | Do not curse the king, not even in your thought, and do not curse the rich in your bedchamber. For a bird of the air shall carry the voice, and that which has wings shall tell the matter. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 5:13-16; Gal 2:12-14
- v3 — Prov 18:2; Prov 13:16
- v4 — Prov 25:15; Eccl 8:3; 1 Sam 25:24-44
- v7 — Prov 19:10; Esth 6:8; Prov 30:22
- v8 — Prov 26:27; Ps 7:15-16; Esth 7:10; Amos 5:19; 2 Sam 17:23
- v10 — Jas 1:5; Col 4:5; Eccl 10:15; 1 Cor 14:20; Eph 5:15-17
- v11 — Ps 58:4-5; Jer 8:17
- v12 — Col 4:6; Luke 4:22; Prov 15:2; Prov 22:11; Eph 4:29
- v14 — Prov 15:2; Eccl 5:3; Eccl 6:12; Eccl 3:22; Jas 4:13-14
- v16 — Isa 3:12; Isa 5:11-12; Isa 3:4-5; Prov 20:1-2
- v18 — Prov 14:1; Prov 20:4; Prov 24:30-34; Prov 21:25; Heb 6:11
- v20 — Acts 23:5; Luke 12:2-3; 2 Kgs 6:12; Ex 22:28; Eccl 7:21-22

Chapter 11

The Preacher urges generosity — cast your bread upon the waters — and diligence in labor, for no man knows what disaster may come. He counsels the young man to rejoice in his youth and walk in the ways of his heart, but warns that God will bring every action into judgment.

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| 1 <i>Cast thy bread upon the waters: for thou shalt find it after many days.</i> | Cast your bread upon the waters, for you shall find it after many days. |
| 2 <i>Give a portion to seven, and also to eight; for thou knowest not what evil shall be upon the earth.</i> | Give a portion to seven, and also to eight, for you do not know what evil shall come upon the earth. |
| 3 <i>If the clouds be full of rain, they empty themselves upon the earth: and if the tree fall toward the south, or toward the north, in the place where the tree falleth, there it shall be.</i> | If the clouds are full of rain, they empty themselves upon the earth. And if a tree falls toward the south, or toward the north, in the place where the tree falls, there it shall lie. |

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| 4 | <i>He that observeth the wind shall not sow; and he that regardeth the clouds shall not reap.</i> | He who watches the wind shall not sow, and he who regards the clouds shall not reap. |
| 5 | <i>As thou knowest not what is the way of the spirit, nor how the bones do grow in the womb of her that is with child: even so thou knowest not the works of God who maketh all.</i> | As you do not know the way of the spirit, nor how the bones grow in the womb of her who is with child, even so you do not know the works of God Who makes all things. |
| 6 | <i>In the morning sow thy seed, and in the evening withhold not thine hand: for thou knowest not whether shall prosper, either this or that, or whether they both shall be alike good.</i> | In the morning sow your seed, and in the evening do not withhold your hand, for you do not know which shall prosper, either this or that, or whether both shall be equally good. |
| 7 | <i>Truly the light is sweet, and a pleasant thing it is for the eyes to behold the sun:</i> | Truly the light is sweet, and it is a pleasant thing for the eyes to see the sun. |
| 8 | <i>But if a man live many years, and rejoice in them all; yet let him remember the days of darkness; for they shall be many. All that cometh is vanity.</i> | But if a man lives many years and rejoices in them all, yet let him remember the days of darkness, for they shall be many. All that comes is vanity. |
| 9 | <i>Rejoice, O young man, in thy youth; and let thy heart cheer thee in the days of thy youth, and walk in the ways of thine heart, and in the sight of thine eyes: but know thou, that for all these things God will bring thee into judgment.</i> | Rejoice, O young man, in your youth, and let your heart cheer you in the days of your youth. Walk in the ways of your heart and in the sight of your eyes. But know that for all these things God will bring you into judgment. |
| 10 | <i>Therefore remove sorrow from thy heart, and put away evil from thy flesh: for childhood and youth are vanity.</i> | Therefore remove sorrow from your heart, and put away evil from your flesh, for childhood and youth are vanity. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eccl 11:6; Prov 19:17; Heb 6:10; Matt 10:42; 2 Cor 9:6
v2 — 1 Tim 6:18-19; Job 5:19; Ps 112:9; Luke 6:30-35; Prov 6:16
v3 — 1 John 3:17; Isa 55:10-11; Ps 65:9-13; Luke 13:7; 1 Kgs 18:45
v4 — Prov 20:4; Prov 3:27; Prov 22:13
v5 — John 3:8; Ps 92:5; Eccl 8:17; Rom 11:33; Isa 40:28
v6 — 2 Cor 9:10-11; Isa 55:10; Hag 1:6-11; Hos 10:12; 2 Cor 9:6
v7 — Matt 5:45; Eccl 7:11; Prov 15:30; Ps 84:11; Job 33:30
v8 — John 12:35; Deut 32:29; Joel 2:2; Eccl 7:14
v9 — Eccl 12:14; 1 John 2:15-16; Eccl 12:1; Eccl 3:17; Lam 3:27
v10 — 2 Cor 7:1; 2 Tim 2:22; Eccl 1:2; Eccl 12:1; Eccl 1:14

Chapter 12

The Preacher urges the young to remember their Creator before old age comes, describing the decline of the body in vivid metaphor — the keepers of the house tremble, the grinders cease, and the silver cord is loosed. He repeats his verdict that all is vanity and delivers the conclusion of the whole matter: fear God and keep His commandments, for God shall bring every work into judgment.

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| <p>¹ <i>Remember now thy Creator in the days of thy youth, while the evil days come not, nor the years draw nigh, when thou shalt say, I have no pleasure in them;</i></p> | <p>Remember now your Creator in the days of your youth, before the evil days come, and the years draw near when you shall say, "I have no pleasure in them";</p> |
| <p>² <i>While the sun, or the light, or the moon, or the stars, be not darkened, nor the clouds return after the rain:</i></p> | <p>while the sun, or the light, or the moon, or the stars are not darkened, nor the clouds return after the rain;</p> |
| <p>³ <i>In the day when the keepers of the house shall tremble, and the strong men shall bow themselves, and the grinders cease because they are few, and those that look out of the windows be darkened,</i></p> | <p>in the day when the keepers of the house shall tremble, and the strong men shall bow themselves, and the grinders cease because they are few, and those who look out of the windows grow dim;</p> |

- 4 *And the doors shall be shut in the streets, when the sound of the grinding is low, and he shall rise up at the voice of the bird, and all the daughters of musick shall be brought low;* when the doors shall be shut in the streets, when the sound of the grinding is low, and one shall rise up at the voice of the bird, and all the daughters of music shall be brought low;
- 5 *Also when they shall be afraid of that which is high, and fears shall be in the way, and the almond tree shall flourish, and the grasshopper shall be a burden, and desire shall fail: because man goeth to his long home, and the mourners go about the streets:* also when they shall be afraid of what is high, and fears shall be in the way, and the almond tree shall blossom, and the grasshopper shall be a burden, and desire shall fail; because man goes to his long home, and the mourners go about the streets.
- 6 *Or ever the silver cord be loosed, or the golden bowl be broken, or the pitcher be broken at the fountain, or the wheel broken at the cistern.* Remember him — before the silver cord is loosed, or the golden bowl is broken, or the pitcher is broken at the fountain, or the wheel broken at the cistern.
- 7 *Then shall the dust return to the earth as it was: and the spirit shall return unto God who gave it.* Then shall the dust return to the earth as it was, and the spirit shall return to God Who gave it.
- 8 *Vanity of vanities, saith the Preacher; all is vanity.* "Vanity of vanities," says the Preacher, "all is vanity."
- 9 *And moreover, because the Preacher was wise, he still taught the people knowledge; yea, he gave good heed, and sought out, and set in order many proverbs.* And moreover, because the Preacher was wise, he still taught the people knowledge. He gave good heed, and sought out, and set in order many proverbs.
- 10 *The Preacher sought to find out acceptable words: and that which was written was upright, even words of truth.* The Preacher sought to find acceptable words, and what was written was upright — even words of truth.

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| <p>11 <i>The words of the wise are as goads, and as nails fastened by the masters of assemblies, which are given from one shepherd.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And further, by these, my son, be admonished: of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.</i></p> | <p>The words of the wise are as goads, and as nails firmly fastened by the masters of assemblies, which are given from one shepherd.</p> <p>And further, my son, be warned by these: of making many books there is no end, and much study is a weariness of the flesh.</p> <p>Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: Fear God, and keep His commandments, for this is the whole duty of man.</p> <p>For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good or whether it be evil.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lam 3:27; Eccl 11:8; Ps 71:17-18; Prov 22:6; Luke 18:16
- v2 — Isa 5:30
- v3 — Ps 90:9-10
- v4 — Jer 25:10
- v5 — Job 17:13; Jer 9:17-20; Job 30:23
- v7 — Dan 12:2; Eccl 3:20-21; Ps 146:4; Gen 3:19; Job 34:14-15
- v8 — Eccl 1:2
- v10 — Col 1:5; 1 Tim 1:15
- v11 — Jer 23:29; Acts 2:37; Heb 4:12; Ezek 34:23; John 3:10
- v12 — Eccl 1:18; John 21:25; 2 Pet 1:19-21; John 5:39; 1 Kgs 4:32
- v13 — Deut 10:12; Mic 6:8; Deut 6:2; Ps 111:10-112:1; Ps 145:19
- v14 — 2 Cor 5:10; Rom 2:16; Matt 12:36; 1 Cor 4:5; Matt 10:26

Song of Solomon

Author: Solomon — the opening verse attributes the song to him by name: "The Song of Songs, which is Solomon's." He is both the named author and one of the two principal speakers.

Date written: c. 970–930 BC, during the reign of Solomon. The lush imagery of gardens, spices, and imported luxuries fits the wealth and peace of Solomon's early kingdom.

Written to: Israel as a whole. Though it reads as a private love poem between a bridegroom and his bride, Jewish tradition placed it in the canon as a picture of God's covenant love for His people, and Christian tradition reads it as a picture of Christ's love for His church.

Setting: The poem moves between the royal court in Jerusalem, the countryside of northern Israel (Lebanon, Sharon, Hermon, Carmel, Engedi), and the vineyards and gardens where the lovers meet. There is no single narrative arc — it is a cycle of songs celebrating desire, separation, reunion, and the permanence of love.

Where this sits historically: Composed early in Solomon's reign (c. 970–960 BC) at the height of the united kingdom, when trade with Phoenicia and Egypt brought the spices, cedars, and luxuries the poem celebrates.

Contemporaries: Solomon wrote alongside Proverbs and Ecclesiastes; the prophet Nathan had recently advised David, and Hiram of Tyre was Solomon's ally in trade and temple-building.

Big themes:

- The goodness of married love — God created physical desire, and Scripture celebrates it within the covenant of marriage
- Longing and seeking — the bride repeatedly searches for her beloved, picturing the soul's pursuit of God
- The exclusivity of love — "I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine" (6:3) — love demands faithfulness
- The strength of love — "love is strong as death; jealousy is cruel as the grave" (8:6) — a statement about the unbreakable nature of true commitment
- Beauty in creation — the poem overflows with imagery drawn from nature: gardens, vineyards, lilies, gazelles, mountains, spices
- Christ and the church — the NT applies bridegroom/bride language to Christ and His people (Ephesians 5:25–32; Revelation 19:7–9); this book is the OT seed of that theology

Key passages: Song of Solomon 2:10–13; 2:16; 4:7; 6:3; 8:6–7

How it fits: Song of Solomon is the only book of the Bible devoted entirely to the celebration of romantic love. It stands in the Wisdom literature alongside Proverbs (which warns against adultery) and Ecclesiastes (which says earthly pleasures are fleeting) — and it answers both by showing that love within God's design is not fleeting but "a most vehement flame" that "many waters cannot quench" (8:6–7). The early church fathers and the Reformers alike read it as a

double portrait: the literal celebration of marriage, and the spiritual picture of Christ who pursues, wins, and delights in His bride the church.

Chapter 1

The bride longs for her beloved's kisses and praises his love as better than wine. She describes herself as dark but lovely, explains that her brothers made her keep the vineyards, and asks where her beloved feeds his flock. The bridegroom praises her beauty, comparing her to a mare among Pharaoh's chariots.

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| 1 | <i>The song of songs, which is Solomon's.</i> | The Song of Songs, which is Solomon's. |
| 2 | <i>Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth: for thy love is better than wine.</i> | Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth, for your love is better than wine. |
| 3 | <i>Because of the savour of thy good ointments thy name is as ointment poured forth; therefore do the virgins love thee.</i> | Because of the fragrance of your good ointments, your name is like ointment poured out. Therefore the young women love you. |
| 4 | <i>Draw me, we will run after thee: the king hath brought me into his chambers: we will be glad and rejoice in thee, we will remember thy love more than wine: the upright love thee.</i> | Draw me, and we will run after you. The king has brought me into his chambers. We will be glad and rejoice in you; we will remember your love more than wine. The upright love you. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Solomon** (SOL-oh-mon) — "peace" — Son of David and Bathsheba; third king of Israel; builder of the Temple in Jerusalem; renowned for his God-given wisdom (1 Kings 3:12) and for his wealth and his many marriages (1 Kings 11:1–3). He is the named author of this song.

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| 5 | <i>I am black, but comely, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, as the tents of Kedar, as the curtains of Solomon.</i> | I am dark, but lovely, O daughters of Jerusalem — like the tents of Kedar, like the curtains of Solomon. |
| 6 | <i>Look not upon me, because I am black, because the sun hath looked upon me: my mother's children were angry with me; they made me the keeper of the vineyards; but mine own vineyard have I not kept.</i> | Do not look down on me because I am dark, because the sun has tanned me. My mother's sons were angry with me; they made me the keeper of the vineyards, but my own vineyard I have not kept. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Kedar** (KEE-dar) — "dark" — A son of Ishmael (Genesis 25:13) and the Arabian tribe descended from him; known for their black goat-hair tents. The bride compares her sun-darkened skin to these tents.

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| <p>7 Tell me, O thou whom my soul loveth, where thou feedest, where thou makest thy flock to rest at noon: for why should I be as one that turneth aside by the flocks of thy companions?</p> <p>8 If thou know not, O thou fairest among women, go thy way forth by the footsteps of the flock, and feed thy kids beside the shepherds' tents.</p> <p>9 I have compared thee, O my love, to a company of horses in Pharaoh's chariots.</p> <p>10 Thy cheeks are comely with rows of jewels, thy neck with chains of gold.</p> <p>11 We will make thee borders of gold with studs of silver.</p> <p>12 While the king sitteth at his table, my spikenard sendeth forth the smell thereof.</p> | <p>Tell me, O you whom my soul loves, where you feed your flock, where you make it rest at noon. For why should I be like one who wanders beside the flocks of your companions?</p> <p>If you do not know, O fairest among women, follow the footsteps of the flock, and feed your young goats beside the shepherds' tents.</p> <p>I compare you, O my love, to a mare among Pharaoh's chariots.</p> <p>Your cheeks are lovely with rows of jewels, your neck with chains of gold.</p> <p>We will make for you ornaments of gold studded with silver.</p> <p>While the king sits at his table, my spikenard sends out its fragrance.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Spikenard** (SPIKE-nard) — A costly aromatic ointment made from the root of the nard plant, imported from India. In the NT, Mary of Bethany anointed Jesus with spikenard worth a year's wages (Mark 14:3; John 12:3).

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| <p>13 A bundle of myrrh is my well-beloved unto me; he shall lie all night betwixt my breasts.</p> <p>14 My beloved is unto me as a cluster of camphire in the vineyards of Engedi.</p> | <p>A bundle of myrrh is my beloved to me; He shall lie all night between my breasts.</p> <p>My beloved is to me a cluster of henna blossoms in the vineyards of Engedi.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Camphire** (KAM-fire) — The KJV word for the henna plant, whose fragrant flower clusters were prized in the ancient Near East. Not related to modern camphor.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Engedi** (en-GEE-dee) — "spring of the wild goat" — An oasis on the western shore of the Dead Sea, famous for its fresh water, vineyards, and aromatic plants. David hid from Saul in the caves of Engedi (1 Samuel 24:1).

- 15

Behold, thou art fair, my love; behold, thou art fair; thou hast doves' eyes.

How fair You are, my love! How fair You are! Your eyes are like doves.
- 16

Behold, thou art fair, my beloved, yea, pleasant: also our bed is green.

How fair You are, my beloved, truly pleasant! Our bed is green with new growth.
- 17

The beams of our house are cedar, and our rafters of fir.

The beams of our house are cedar, and our rafters are fir.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Song 4:10; Ps 36:7; Song 1:4
- v3 — Eccl 7:1; Song 4:10; John 12:3; Ex 30:23-28; Ps 45:7-8
- v4 — John 6:44; Hos 11:4; Ps 45:14-15; John 12:32
- v5 — Luke 15:22; Song 2:14; Song 5:8; Ps 120:5; Song 2:7
- v6 — Song 8:11-12; Luke 12:51-53
- v7 — Song 3:1-4; Isa 13:20
- v8 — Song 6:1; Song 5:9
- v9 — Song 2:10; Song 2:13
- v10 — Ezek 16:11-13; 1 Pet 3:4
- v12 — John 12:3; Rev 3:20
- v13 — John 19:39
- v15 — Song 4:1; Song 5:12

Chapter 2

The bride calls herself the rose of Sharon and the lily of the valleys. The bridegroom calls her a lily among thorns. She describes sitting under his shadow with delight and being brought to his banqueting house, where his banner over her is love. He calls her to come away, for winter is past and the time of singing has come.

- 1

I am the rose of Sharon, and the lily of the valleys.

I am the rose of Sharon and the lily of the valleys.
- 2

As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters.

As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sharon** (SHARE-on) — *The broad, fertile coastal plain stretching south from Mount Carmel along the Mediterranean. Known for its rich pasture and wildflowers; "the rose of Sharon" became a byword for beauty.*

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| <p>3 <i>As the apple tree among the trees of the wood, so is my beloved among the sons. I sat down under his shadow with great delight, and his fruit was sweet to my taste.</i></p> | <p>As the apple tree among the trees of the forest, so is my beloved among the sons. I sat down under his shadow with great delight, and his fruit was sweet to my taste.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>He brought me to the banqueting house, and his banner over me was love.</i></p> | <p>He brought me to the banqueting house, and his banner over me was love.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Stay me with flagons, comfort me with apples: for I am sick of love.</i></p> | <p>Sustain me with raisin cakes, refresh me with apples, for I am sick with love.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>His left hand is under my head, and his right hand doth embrace me.</i></p> | <p>His left hand is under my head, and his right hand embraces me.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>I charge you, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, and by the hinds of the field, that ye stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.</i></p> | <p>I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, by the gazelles and by the does of the field: do not stir up nor awaken love until it pleases.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>The voice of my beloved! behold, he cometh leaping upon the mountains, skipping upon the hills.</i></p> | <p>The voice of my beloved! He comes leaping on the mountains, bounding on the hills.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>My beloved is like a roe or a young hart: behold, he standeth behind our wall, he looketh forth at the windows, shewing himself through the lattice.</i></p> | <p>My beloved is like a gazelle or a young stag. There he stands behind our wall; he looks in at the windows, showing himself through the lattice.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>My beloved spake, and said unto me, Rise up, my love, my fair one, and come away.</i></p> | <p>My beloved spoke and said to me, "Rise up, my love, my fair one, and come away.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>For, lo, the winter is past, the rain is over and gone;</i></p> | <p>For the winter is past; the rain is over and gone.</p> |

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| <p>12 <i>The flowers appear on the earth; the time of the singing of birds is come, and the voice of the turtle is heard in our land;</i></p> <p>13 <i>The fig tree putteth forth her green figs, and the vines with the tender grape give a good smell. Arise, my love, my fair one, and come away.</i></p> <p>14 <i>O my dove, that art in the clefts of the rock, in the secret places of the stairs, let me see thy countenance, let me hear thy voice; for sweet is thy voice, and thy countenance is comely.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Take us the foxes, the little foxes, that spoil the vines: for our vines have tender grapes.</i></p> <p>16 <i>My beloved is mine, and I am his: he feedeth among the lilies.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, turn, my beloved, and be thou like a roe or a young hart upon the mountains of Bether.</i></p> | <p>The flowers appear on the earth; the time of singing has come, and the voice of the turtledove is heard in our land.</p> <p>The fig tree puts forth her green figs, and the vines with their tender grapes give a sweet fragrance. Rise up, my love, my fair one, and come away."</p> <p>O my dove, in the clefts of the rock, in the secret places of the cliff, let me see your countenance, let me hear your voice. For sweet is your voice, and your countenance is lovely.</p> <p>Catch the foxes for us — the little foxes that spoil the vines — for our vines have tender grapes.</p> <p>My beloved is mine, and I am his; he feeds among the lilies.</p> <p>Until the day breaks and the shadows flee away, turn, my beloved, and be like a gazelle or a young stag on the mountains of Bether.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bether** (BEE-ther) — "separation, division" — A place name of uncertain location; possibly the rugged hills between the lovers. Some read it as "the cleft mountains," a metaphor for separation.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hos 14:5; Isa 57:15; Isa 35:1-2; Song 5:13
- v3 — Song 8:5; Isa 25:4; Isa 32:2; Heb 1:1-6; Heb 12:2
- v4 — Song 1:4; Rom 5:8-10; Rom 8:28-39; John 15:9-15; Rev 3:20
- v6 — Zeph 3:17; Isa 54:5-10
- v7 — Song 3:5; Song 8:4
- v8 — John 10:27
- v9 — Song 8:14; Song 2:17

v10 — Song 4:7-8; Song 2:13

v11 — Isa 60:1-2

v14 — Song 1:5; Ezra 9:5-6; Song 5:2

v15 — Luke 13:32; 2 Pet 2:1-3; Song 7:12; Ps 80:13; Ezek 13:4-16

v16 — Song 6:3; Song 7:10

Chapter 3

The bride searches for her beloved by night through the city streets and finds him after passing the watchmen. She charges the daughters of Jerusalem not to stir up love until it pleases. The poem then describes Solomon's royal procession from the wilderness, his bed guarded by sixty mighty men, and the crown his mother placed on him on his wedding day.

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| <p>1 <i>By night on my bed I sought him
whom my soul loveth: I sought him,
but I found him not.</i></p> | <p>By night on my bed I sought him
whom my soul loves. I sought him, but
I did not find him.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>I will rise now, and go about the city
in the streets, and in the broad ways I
will seek him whom my soul loveth: I
sought him, but I found him not.</i></p> | <p>"I will rise now and go about the city
— through the streets and the broad
ways — I will seek him whom my soul
loves." I sought him, but I did not find
him.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The watchmen that go about the city
found me: to whom I said, Saw ye him
whom my soul loveth?</i></p> | <p>The watchmen who go about the city
found me. I said to them, "Have you
seen him whom my soul loves?"</p> |
| <p>4 <i>It was but a little that I passed from
them, but I found him whom my soul
loveth: I held him, and would not let
him go, until I had brought him into
my mother's house, and into the
chamber of her that conceived me.</i></p> | <p>I had scarcely passed them when I
found him whom my soul loves. I held
him and would not let him go, until I
had brought him to my mother's house,
into the room of her who conceived
me.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>I charge you, O ye daughters of
Jerusalem, by the roes, and by the
hinds of the field, that ye stir not up,
nor awake my love, till he please.</i></p> | <p>I charge you, O daughters of
Jerusalem, by the gazelles and by the
does of the field: do not stir up nor
awaken love until it pleases.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>Who is this that cometh out of the wilderness like pillars of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, with all powders of the merchant?</i></p> <p>7 <i>Behold his bed, which is Solomon's; threescore valiant men are about it, of the valiant of Israel.</i></p> <p>8 <i>They all hold swords, being expert in war: every man hath his sword upon his thigh because of fear in the night.</i></p> <p>9 <i>King Solomon made himself a chariot of the wood of Lebanon.</i></p> <p>10 <i>He made the pillars thereof of silver, the bottom thereof of gold, the covering of it of purple, the midst thereof being paved with love, for the daughters of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Go forth, O ye daughters of Zion, and behold king Solomon with the crown wherewith his mother crowned him in the day of his espousals, and in the day of the gladness of his heart.</i></p> | <p>Who is this coming out of the wilderness like pillars of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, with all the fragrant powders of the merchant?</p> <p>See, it is the bed of Solomon, with sixty valiant men around it — the mighty men of Israel.</p> <p>They all hold swords, skilled in war. Every man has his sword on his thigh because of the terrors of the night.</p> <p>King Solomon made himself a royal carriage of the wood of Lebanon.</p> <p>He made its pillars of silver, its base of gold, its seat of purple. Its interior was lovingly fitted by the daughters of Jerusalem.</p> <p>Go forth, O daughters of Zion, and see King Solomon wearing the crown his mother placed on him on the day of his wedding — the day of the gladness of his heart.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zion** (ZY-on) — "fortress" — *Originally the Jebusite stronghold David captured (2 Samuel 5:7); it became a name for Jerusalem as a whole and especially for the city as God's dwelling place. "Daughters of Zion" means the women of Jerusalem.*

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 1:8; Song 1:7; Song 5:6; Isa 55:6; Isa 26:9
- v3 — Song 5:7
- v4 — Prov 8:17
- v5 — Song 2:7; Song 8:4
- v6 — Song 8:5
- v11 — Isa 62:5

Chapter 4

The bridegroom praises his bride from head to foot — her eyes like doves, her hair like a flock of goats, her lips like scarlet thread — and declares there is no flaw in her. He calls her from Lebanon and says she has stolen his heart. He describes her as a garden enclosed, a fountain sealed, overflowing with every precious spice. The bride invites the winds to blow upon her garden so its fragrance may reach her beloved.

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| <p>1 <i>Behold, thou art fair, my love; behold, thou art fair; thou hast doves' eyes within thy locks: thy hair is as a flock of goats, that appear from mount Gilead.</i></p> | <p>How fair you are, my love! How fair you are! Your eyes are like doves behind your veil. Your hair is like a flock of goats streaming down from Mount Gilead.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thy teeth are like a flock of sheep that are even shorn, which came up from the washing; whereof every one bear twins, and none is barren among them.</i></p> | <p>Your teeth are like a flock of newly shorn sheep coming up from the washing, each one bearing twins, and none barren among them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Thy lips are like a thread of scarlet, and thy speech is comely: thy temples are like a piece of a pomegranate within thy locks.</i></p> | <p>Your lips are like a thread of scarlet, and your speech is lovely. Your temples behind your veil are like a piece of pomegranate.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Thy neck is like the tower of David builded for an armoury, whereon there hang a thousand bucklers, all shields of mighty men.</i></p> | <p>Your neck is like the tower of David, built as an armory, on which hang a thousand bucklers — all shields of mighty men.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gilead** (GIL-ee-ad) — "rocky region" — *The mountainous territory east of the Jordan River, known for its rich pastureland, its flocks, and its healing balm (Jeremiah 8:22). The flocks of Gilead were proverbially beautiful.*

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| <p>5 <i>Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins, which feed among the lilies.</i></p> | <p>Your two breasts are like two young gazelles that are twins, feeding among the lilies.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, I will get me to the mountain of myrrh, and to the hill of frankincense.</i></p> | <p>Until the day breaks and the shadows flee away, I will go to the mountain of myrrh and to the hill of frankincense.</p> |

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| 7 <i>Thou art all fair, my love; there is no spot in thee.</i> | You are altogether fair, my love; there is no flaw in you. |
| 8 <i>Come with me from Lebanon, my spouse, with me from Lebanon: look from the top of Amana, from the top of Shenir and Hermon, from the lions' dens, from the mountains of the leopards.</i> | Come with me from Lebanon, my bride — with me from Lebanon. Look from the top of Amana, from the top of Shenir and Hermon, from the lions' dens, from the mountains of the leopards. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lebanon** (LEB-ah-non) — "white" (from its snow-capped peaks) — The mountain range north of Israel, famous for its towering cedars. Solomon imported cedar from Lebanon to build the Temple (1 Kings 5:6). In the Song it represents majesty, fragrance, and remote beauty.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amana** (ah-MAH-nah) — "firmness, constancy" — A peak in the Anti-Lebanon range, near the source of the Abana River (2 Kings 5:12). Listed alongside Hermon as a high, wild place.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Shenir** (SHEE-nir) — The Amorite name for Mount Hermon (Deuteronomy 3:9); sometimes used for a neighboring peak in the same range.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hermon** (HER-mon) — "sacred mountain" — The highest peak in the region (over 9,000 feet), marking the northern boundary of the Promised Land. Its snow-fed streams water the Jordan River. Psalm 133:3 compares the dew of Hermon to the blessing of God.

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| 9 <i>Thou hast ravished my heart, my sister, my spouse; thou hast ravished my heart with one of thine eyes, with one chain of thy neck.</i> | You have stolen my heart, my sister, my bride. You have stolen my heart with one glance of your eyes, with one jewel of your necklace. |
| 10 <i>How fair is thy love, my sister, my spouse! how much better is thy love than wine! and the smell of thine ointments than all spices!</i> | How fair is your love, my sister, my bride! How much better is your love than wine, and the fragrance of your ointments than all spices! |
| 11 <i>Thy lips, O my spouse, drop as the honeycomb: honey and milk are under thy tongue; and the smell of thy garments is like the smell of Lebanon.</i> | Your lips, O my bride, drip as the honeycomb. Honey and milk are under your tongue, and the fragrance of your garments is like the fragrance of Lebanon. |

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| <p>12 <i>A garden inclosed is my sister, my spouse; a spring shut up, a fountain sealed.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Thy plants are an orchard of pomegranates, with pleasant fruits; camphire, with spikenard,</i></p> <p>14 <i>Spikenard and saffron; calamus and cinnamon, with all trees of frankincense; myrrh and aloes, with all the chief spices:</i></p> <p>15 <i>A fountain of gardens, a well of living waters, and streams from Lebanon.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Awake, O north wind; and come, thou south; blow upon my garden, that the spices thereof may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden, and eat his pleasant fruits.</i></p> | <p>A garden enclosed is my sister, my bride — a spring shut up, a fountain sealed.</p> <p>Your plants are an orchard of pomegranates with pleasant fruits — henna with spikenard,</p> <p>spikenard and saffron, calamus and cinnamon, with all trees of frankincense — myrrh and aloes, with all the finest spices.</p> <p>You are a fountain of gardens, a well of living waters, and streams flowing from Lebanon.</p> <p>Awake, O north wind, and come, O south wind! Blow upon my garden, that its spices may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden and eat its pleasant fruits.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Song 6:5; Song 1:15; Song 6:7
- v2 — Song 6:6
- v3 — Song 6:7
- v4 — Song 7:4
- v6 — Song 2:17
- v7 — Song 1:15; Song 4:1; Eph 5:25-27; Jude 1:24; Col 1:22
- v8 — Deut 3:9; Song 2:13
- v9 — Prov 5:19-20; Song 5:1-2; Song 4:12
- v12 — Prov 5:15-18; Rev 21:27
- v13 — Song 1:14; Song 6:11; Eccl 2:5
- v14 — Ex 30:23; Song 4:6
- v16 — Song 6:2; Song 5:1

Chapter 5

The bridegroom enters his garden. The bride hesitates to open the door to her beloved, and when she rises he is gone. She searches for him through the city and the watchmen strike and wound her. The daughters of Jerusalem ask what makes her beloved special, and she describes him in lavish detail — his head like fine gold, his eyes like doves, his mouth most sweet — declaring he is altogether lovely.

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| <p>1 I am come into my garden, my sister, my spouse: I have gathered my myrrh with my spice; I have eaten my honeycomb with my honey; I have drunk my wine with my milk: eat, O friends; drink, yea, drink abundantly, O beloved.</p> | <p>I have come into my garden, my sister, my bride. I have gathered my myrrh with my spice; I have eaten my honeycomb with my honey; I have drunk my wine with my milk. Eat, O friends! Drink — drink deeply, O beloved.</p> |
| <p>2 I sleep, but my heart waketh: it is the voice of my beloved that knocketh, saying, Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled: for my head is filled with dew, and my locks with the drops of the night.</p> | <p>I sleep, but my heart is awake. It is the voice of my beloved! He knocks, saying, "Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled one, for my head is filled with dew, and my locks with the drops of the night."</p> |
| <p>3 I have put off my coat; how shall I put it on? I have washed my feet; how shall I defile them?</p> | <p>I have taken off my robe — how shall I put it on again? I have washed my feet — how shall I soil them?</p> |
| <p>4 My beloved put in his hand by the hole of the door, and my bowels were moved for him.</p> | <p>My beloved put his hand through the opening of the door, and my heart yearned for him.</p> |
| <p>5 I rose up to open to my beloved; and my hands dropped with myrrh, and my fingers with sweet smelling myrrh, upon the handles of the lock.</p> | <p>I rose to open to my beloved, and my hands dripped with myrrh — my fingers with liquid myrrh — on the handles of the lock.</p> |
| <p>6 I opened to my beloved; but my beloved had withdrawn himself, and was gone: my soul failed when he spake: I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer.</p> | <p>I opened to my beloved, but my beloved had turned away and was gone. My soul failed when he spoke. I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer.</p> |

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| <p>7 <i>The watchmen that went about the city found me, they smote me, they wounded me; the keepers of the walls took away my veil from me.</i></p> <p>8 <i>I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, if ye find my beloved, that ye tell him, that I am sick of love.</i></p> <p>9 <i>What is thy beloved more than another beloved, O thou fairest among women? what is thy beloved more than another beloved, that thou dost so charge us?</i></p> <p>10 <i>My beloved is white and ruddy, the chiefest among ten thousand.</i></p> <p>11 <i>His head is as the most fine gold, his locks are bushy, and black as a raven.</i></p> <p>12 <i>His eyes are as the eyes of doves by the rivers of waters, washed with milk, and fitly set.</i></p> <p>13 <i>His cheeks are as a bed of spices, as sweet flowers: his lips like lilies, dropping sweet smelling myrrh.</i></p> <p>14 <i>His hands are as gold rings set with the beryl: his belly is as bright ivory overlaid with sapphires.</i></p> <p>15 <i>His legs are as pillars of marble, set upon sockets of fine gold: his countenance is as Lebanon, excellent as the cedars.</i></p> <p>16 <i>His mouth is most sweet: yea, he is altogether lovely. This is my beloved, and this is my friend, O daughters of Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>The watchmen who went about the city found me. They struck me, they wounded me; the keepers of the walls took my veil from me.</p> <p>I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem — if you find my beloved, tell him that I am sick with love.</p> <p>What is your beloved more than another beloved, O fairest among women? What is your beloved more than another, that you so charge us?</p> <p>My beloved is radiant and ruddy, the chief among ten thousand.</p> <p>His head is like the finest gold; his locks are wavy and black as a raven.</p> <p>His eyes are like doves beside streams of water, washed with milk, set like jewels.</p> <p>His cheeks are like a bed of spices, like banks of fragrant herbs. His lips are like lilies, dripping with liquid myrrh.</p> <p>His hands are like rings of gold set with beryl. His body is like polished ivory overlaid with sapphires.</p> <p>His legs are like pillars of marble set on bases of fine gold. His countenance is like Lebanon, excellent as the cedars.</p> <p>His mouth is most sweet; he is altogether lovely. This is my beloved, and this is my friend, O daughters of Jerusalem.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Song 6:2; Song 4:16; Song 4:9-14; Rev 22:17
- v2 — Rev 3:20; Song 2:14
- v5 — Song 5:13
- v6 — Song 5:2
- v7 — Song 3:3
- v8 — Song 2:5; Song 2:7
- v9 — Song 1:8; Song 6:1
- v12 — Song 1:15; Song 4:1
- v13 — Song 1:10

Chapter 6

The daughters of Jerusalem ask where the beloved has gone, and the bride answers that he has gone down to his garden. She declares, "I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine." The bridegroom praises her beauty as like Tirzah and awesome as an army with banners. Among sixty queens and eighty concubines, his dove, his undefiled one, stands alone. The daughters call for the Shulamite to return.

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| 1 | <i>Whither is thy beloved gone, O thou fairest among women? whither is thy beloved turned aside? that we may seek him with thee.</i> | Where has your beloved gone, O fairest among women? Where has your beloved turned aside, that we may seek him with you? |
| 2 | <i>My beloved is gone down into his garden, to the beds of spices, to feed in the gardens, and to gather lilies.</i> | My beloved has gone down to his garden, to the beds of spices, to feed in the gardens and to gather lilies. |
| 3 | <i>I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine: he feedeth among the lilies.</i> | I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine; he feeds among the lilies. |
| 4 | <i>Thou art beautiful, O my love, as Tirzah, comely as Jerusalem, terrible as an army with banners.</i> | You are beautiful, O my love, as Tirzah, lovely as Jerusalem, awesome as an army with banners. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tirzah** (TIR-zah) — "pleasant, delightful" — An ancient Canaanite city that later served as the capital of the northern kingdom of Israel before Omri built Samaria (1 Kings 16:23). Its beauty was proverbial — the bridegroom compares his bride to Tirzah and Jerusalem in the same breath.

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| <p>5 <i>Turn away thine eyes from me, for they have overcome me: thy hair is as a flock of goats that appear from Gilead.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Thy teeth are as a flock of sheep which go up from the washing, whereof every one beareth twins, and there is not one barren among them.</i></p> <p>7 <i>As a piece of a pomegranate are thy temples within thy locks.</i></p> <p>8 <i>There are threescore queens, and fourscore concubines, and virgins without number.</i></p> <p>9 <i>My dove, my undefiled is but one; she is the only one of her mother, she is the choice one of her that bare her. The daughters saw her, and blessed her; yea, the queens and the concubines, and they praised her.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Who is she that looketh forth as the morning, fair as the moon, clear as the sun, and terrible as an army with banners?</i></p> <p>11 <i>I went down into the garden of nuts to see the fruits of the valley, and to see whether the vine flourished, and the pomegranates budded.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Or ever I was aware, my soul made me like the chariots of Amminadib.</i></p> | <p>Turn your eyes away from me, for they have overcome me. Your hair is like a flock of goats streaming down from Gilead.</p> <p>Your teeth are like a flock of sheep coming up from the washing, each one bearing twins, and not one barren among them.</p> <p>Your temples behind your veil are like a piece of pomegranate.</p> <p>There are sixty queens and eighty concubines and young women without number,</p> <p>but my dove, my undefiled one, is the only one. She is the only one of her mother, the choice one of her who bore her. The daughters saw her and called her blessed; the queens and the concubines praised her.</p> <p>Who is she who looks forth like the morning, fair as the moon, clear as the sun, awesome as an army with banners?</p> <p>I went down to the garden of nuts to see the fresh growth of the valley, to see whether the vine had budded and the pomegranates were in bloom.</p> <p>Before I was aware, my desire set me among the chariots of my noble people.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amminadib** (ah-MIN-ah-dib) — "my people are willing / my noble people" — A name of uncertain reference in this verse. Some read it as a proper name; others take it as a description ("my princely people"). The KJV preserves the form; the sense is that the speaker was suddenly swept up as if riding in a royal chariot.

- 13 *Return, return, O Shulamite; return, return, that we may look upon thee. What will ye see in the Shulamite? As it were the company of two armies.* *Return, return, O Shulamite! Return, return, that we may look upon you! What will you see in the Shulamite? As it were the dance of two companies.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Shulamite** (SHOO-lah-mite) — The title given to the bride. It may be the feminine form of "Solomon" (both from the Hebrew root *shalom*, "peace"), making her "the peaceful one" — Solomon's counterpart. Others connect it to the village of Shunem in the Jezreel Valley.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Song 1:8; Song 5:9; Jer 14:8; Ruth 2:12
 v2 — Song 5:13
 v3 — Song 2:16; Song 7:10; Heb 8:10
 v4 — Song 6:10; Ps 48:2
 v6 — Song 4:2
 v7 — Song 4:3
 v8 — Ps 45:14; 1 Kgs 11:3; 1 Kgs 11:1; 2 Chr 11:21; Ps 45:9
 v9 — Song 2:14; Gen 30:13; Ps 45:9; Song 5:2; Rev 21:9-10
 v10 — Song 6:4
 v11 — Song 7:12
 v13 — Gen 32:2

Chapter 7

The bridegroom praises the bride from foot to head — her feet in sandals, her stature like a palm tree, her head like Carmel. The bride declares, "I am my beloved's, and his desire is toward me," and invites him to go out into the fields and vineyards where she will give him her love.

- 1 *How beautiful are thy feet with shoes, O prince's daughter! the joints of thy thighs are like jewels, the work of the hands of a cunning workman.* *How beautiful are your feet in sandals, O prince's daughter! The curves of your thighs are like jewels, the work of the hands of a master craftsman.*
- 2 *Thy navel is like a round goblet, which wanteth not liquor: thy belly is like an heap of wheat set about with lilies.* *Your navel is like a round goblet that never lacks blended wine. Your waist is like a heap of wheat set about with lilies.*

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| 3 | Thy two breasts are like two young
roes that are twins. | Your two breasts are like two young
gazelles that are twins. |
| 4 | Thy neck is as a tower of ivory; thine
eyes like the fishpools in Heshbon, by
the gate of Bathrabbim: thy nose is as
the tower of Lebanon which looketh
toward Damascus. | Your neck is like a tower of ivory.
Your eyes are like the pools in
Heshbon by the gate of Bathrabbim.
Your nose is like the tower of Lebanon
which looks toward Damascus. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Heshbon** (HESH-bon) — "reckoning" — An ancient city east of the Jordan, originally the capital of Sihon king of the Amorites (Numbers 21:26), later an Israelite city. Known for its pools and reservoirs.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bathrabbim** (bath-RAB-im) — "daughter of many" — A gate of the city of Heshbon; named for the multitudes who passed through it.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Damascus** (dah-MAS-kus) — One of the oldest continuously inhabited cities in the world; capital of Syria (Aram). Located northeast of Israel, it was both a trading partner and a recurring enemy throughout Israel's history.

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| 5 | Thine head upon thee is like Carmel,
and the hair of thine head like purple;
the king is held in the galleries. | Your head crowns you like Carmel,
and the hair of your head is like royal
purple; the king is held captive in its
tresses. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Carmel** (KAR-mel) — "garden-land, fruitful field" — The prominent headland on the Mediterranean coast of Israel, lush with vegetation. Site of Elijah's confrontation with the prophets of Baal (1 Kings 18). Here used as an image of stately beauty.

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| 6 | How fair and how pleasant art thou,
O love, for delights! | How fair and how pleasant you are, O
love, for delights! |
| 7 | This thy stature is like to a palm tree,
and thy breasts to clusters of grapes. | Your stature is like a palm tree, and
your breasts like clusters of grapes. |
| 8 | I said, I will go up to the palm tree, I
will take hold of the boughs thereof:
now also thy breasts shall be as
clusters of the vine, and the smell of
thy nose like apples; | I said, "I will climb the palm tree; I
will take hold of its branches." Now
your breasts shall be like clusters of the
vine, the fragrance of your breath like
apples, |

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| <p>9 <i>And the roof of thy mouth like the best wine for my beloved, that goeth down sweetly, causing the lips of those that are asleep to speak.</i></p> <p>10 <i>I am my beloved's, and his desire is toward me.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Come, my beloved, let us go forth into the field; let us lodge in the villages.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Let us get up early to the vineyards; let us see if the vine flourish, whether the tender grape appear, and the pomegranates bud forth: there will I give thee my loves.</i></p> <p>13 <i>The mandrakes give a smell, and at our gates are all manner of pleasant fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for thee, O my beloved.</i></p> | <p>and the roof of your mouth like the best wine for my beloved, going down sweetly, causing the lips of those who are asleep to speak.</p> <p>I am my beloved's, and his desire is toward me.</p> <p>Come, my beloved, let us go out into the field; let us lodge in the villages.</p> <p>Let us go up early to the vineyards. Let us see whether the vine has flowered, whether the tender grapes have appeared, and the pomegranates are in bud. There I will give you my love.</p> <p>The mandrakes give off their fragrance, and at our gates are all kinds of pleasant fruits — new and old — which I have stored up for you, O my beloved.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 45:13
- v3 — Song 4:5
- v4 — Song 4:4
- v6 — Ps 45:11; Song 1:15-16; Song 4:10; Song 7:10; Isa 62:4-5
- v9 — Song 5:16
- v10 — Ps 45:11; Song 6:3; Song 2:16
- v12 — Song 6:11
- v13 — Gen 30:14

Chapter 8

The bride longs for open affection with her beloved and again charges the daughters of Jerusalem not to awaken love before its time. She declares that love is strong as death, jealousy fierce as the grave, and its flames are a most vehement flame that many waters cannot quench. The brothers speak of guarding their young sister, and the bride offers her own vineyard freely, telling Solomon to keep his thousand.

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| <p>1 <i>O that thou wert as my brother, that sucked the breasts of my mother! when I should find thee without, I would kiss thee; yea, I should not be despised.</i></p> <p>2 <i>I would lead thee, and bring thee into my mother's house, who would instruct me: I would cause thee to drink of spiced wine of the juice of my pomegranate.</i></p> <p>3 <i>His left hand should be under my head, and his right hand should embrace me.</i></p> <p>4 <i>I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, that ye stir not up, nor awake my love, until he please.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Who is this that cometh up from the wilderness, leaning upon her beloved? I raised thee up under the apple tree: there thy mother brought thee forth: there she brought thee forth that bare thee.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Set me as a seal upon thine heart, as a seal upon thine arm: for love is strong as death; jealousy is cruel as the grave: the coals thereof are coals of fire, which hath a most vehement flame.</i></p> | <p>Oh, that you were like my brother who nursed at my mother's breasts! If I found you outside, I would kiss you, and no one would despise me.</p> <p>I would lead you and bring you into my mother's house — she who taught me. I would give you spiced wine to drink, the juice of my pomegranate.</p> <p>His left hand would be under my head, and his right hand would embrace me.</p> <p>I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem: do not stir up nor awaken love until it pleases.</p> <p>Who is this coming up from the wilderness, leaning on her beloved? I awakened you under the apple tree. There your mother labored with you; there she who bore you was in labor.</p> <p>Set me as a seal upon your heart, as a seal upon your arm. For love is strong as death; jealousy is fierce as the grave. Its flames are flames of fire — a most vehement flame.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE — A most vehement flame** — *The Hebrew here is shalhebethyah, literally "the flame of the LORD" (or "the flame of Yah"). This is the only place in the Song where God's name appears. The KJV renders it "a most vehement flame," but the underlying Hebrew declares that the fire of true love is kindled by God Himself.*

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| <p>7 <i>Many waters cannot quench love, neither can the floods drown it: if a man would give all the substance of his house for love, it would utterly be contemned.</i></p> <p>8 <i>We have a little sister, and she hath no breasts: what shall we do for our sister in the day when she shall be spoken for?</i></p> <p>9 <i>If she be a wall, we will build upon her a palace of silver: and if she be a door, we will inclose her with boards of cedar.</i></p> <p>10 <i>I am a wall, and my breasts like towers: then was I in his eyes as one that found favour.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Solomon had a vineyard at Baalhamon; he let out the vineyard unto keepers; every one for the fruit thereof was to bring a thousand pieces of silver.</i></p> | <p>Many waters cannot quench love, nor can the floods drown it. If a man would give all the wealth of his house for love, it would be utterly scorned.</p> <p>We have a little sister, and she has no breasts yet. What shall we do for our sister on the day when she is spoken for?</p> <p>If she is a wall, we will build upon her a battlement of silver. If she is a door, we will enclose her with boards of cedar.</p> <p>I am a wall, and my breasts are like towers. Then I was in His eyes as one who found favor.</p> <p>Solomon had a vineyard at Baalhamon. He leased the vineyard to keepers; each one was to bring a thousand pieces of silver for its fruit.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Baalhamon** (bay-al-HAY-mon) — "lord of a multitude" — A place name appearing only here in Scripture; the location of Solomon's vineyard. Its meaning fits the context: Solomon's vast holdings are contrasted with the bride's singular vineyard, which is hers alone.

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| <p>12 <i>My vineyard, which is mine, is before me: thou, O Solomon, must have a thousand, and those that keep the fruit thereof two hundred.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Thou that dwellest in the gardens, the companions hearken to thy voice: cause me to hear it.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Make haste, my beloved, and be thou like a roe or to a young hart upon the mountains of spices.</i></p> | <p>My vineyard, which is mine, is before me. You, O Solomon, may have your thousand, and those who tend its fruit two hundred.</p> <p>You who dwell in the gardens, the companions listen for your voice — let me hear it.</p> <p>Make haste, my beloved! Be like a gazelle or a young stag on the mountains of spices.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v2 — Song 3:4

v3 — Song 2:6

v4 — Song 2:7; Song 3:5

v5 — Song 3:6; Isa 40:3

v6 — Rev 12:11; Isa 49:16; Phil 1:20-23; Prov 6:34; Song 5:8

v7 — Prov 6:35; Rom 13:8-10; Prov 6:31; Isa 43:2

v11 — Eccl 2:4; Isa 7:23

v14 — Song 2:17

Isaiah

Author: Isaiah son of Amoz — the book names him as its author (Isa 1:1), Christ quotes it as Isaiah's (Matt 12:17–21, 13:14–15), and the NT cites it more than any other OT prophet.

Date written: c. 740–680 BC, spanning the reigns of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.

Written to: The southern kingdom of Judah, with prophetic vision extending to Babylon, the nations, and the end of days.

Setting: The northern kingdom of Israel is about to fall to Assyria (722 BC). Judah faces the same threat and the same temptation — to trust foreign alliances rather than God. Isaiah ministers for over forty years through this crisis, warning of judgment and promising restoration.

Where this sits historically: Written under Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah (c. 740–680 BC), as the Assyrian empire under Tiglath-Pileser III, Shalmaneser V, Sargon II, and Sennacherib destroyed Samaria in 722 BC and besieged Jerusalem in 701 BC.

Contemporaries: Micah, Hosea, and Amos were prophesying in the same window, while Jonah had recently been sent to Nineveh and the divided kingdom watched the northern tribes carried into Assyrian exile.

Big themes:

- The holiness of God — Isaiah's call vision (ch. 6) establishes the foundation: God is holy, man is unclean, and only a divine act of cleansing makes ministry possible

- Judgment on Judah and the nations — the first half of the book (chs. 1–39) pronounces judgment on sin and unfaithfulness

- The Servant of the LORD — four "Servant Songs" (42, 49, 50, 53) describe a figure who suffers for the sins of the people; chapter 53 is the clearest prophecy of the atonement in all the OT

- The new creation — the second half (chs. 40–66) promises comfort, restoration, and ultimately a new heavens and new earth

- Messianic prophecy — Isaiah contains more explicit messianic prophecies than any other OT book: the virgin birth (7:14), the child born (9:6), the shoot from Jesse's root (11:1), the suffering servant (53)

Key passages: Isa 6:3; 7:14; 9:6–7; 40:31; 53:5–6

How it fits: Isaiah stands at the turning point of OT history — the Assyrian threat, the Babylonian exile on the horizon, and the promise of a coming Servant who will do what no king could. The NT quotes Isaiah more than any other prophet. Jesus opened His ministry by reading Isaiah 61 in the synagogue at Nazareth.

Chapter 1

The LORD rebukes Judah as a sinful nation whose sacrifices and feasts He despises because their hands are full of blood. He calls them to wash themselves, cease doing evil, and learn to do good, promising that though their sins are as scarlet they shall be white as snow.

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| <p>1 <i>The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.</i></p> | <p>The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Isaiah** (eye-ZAY-uh) — "the LORD is salvation" — Prophet to Judah for over 60 years, son of Amoz, who served under four kings.

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| <p>2 <i>Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth: for the LORD hath spoken, I have nourished and brought up children, and they have rebelled against me.</i></p> | <p>Hear, O heavens, and listen, O earth, for the LORD has spoken. I have nourished and raised children, and they have rebelled against Me.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The ox knoweth his owner, and the ass his master's crib: but Israel doth not know, my people doth not consider.</i></p> | <p>The ox knows its owner, and the donkey its master's stall, but Israel does not know; My people do not consider.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Ah sinful nation, a people laden with iniquity, a seed of evildoers, children that are corrupters: they have forsaken the LORD, they have provoked the Holy One of Israel unto anger, they are gone away backward.</i></p> | <p>A sinful nation, a people loaded down with iniquity, a seed of evildoers, children who are corrupters! They have forsaken the LORD; they have provoked the Holy One of Israel to anger; they have turned away backward.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIH-kwih-tee) — "deep, twisted wrongdoing." Stronger than "sin" — it points to the corruption beneath the sinful act, the bent that produces the wrong.

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| <p>5 <i>Why should ye be stricken any more? ye will revolt more and more: the whole head is sick, and the whole heart faint.</i></p> | <p>Why should You be struck anymore? You will only rebel more and more. The whole head is sick, and the whole heart is faint.</p> |
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- 6 *From the sole of the foot even unto the head there is no soundness in it; but wounds, and bruises, and putrifying sores: they have not been closed, neither bound up, neither mollified with ointment.* From the sole of the foot even to the head, there is no soundness in it — only wounds, bruises, and festering sores. They have not been closed, nor bound up, nor soothed with ointment.
- 7 *Your country is desolate, your cities are burned with fire: your land, strangers devour it in your presence, and it is desolate, as overthrown by strangers.* Your country is desolate; Your cities are burned with fire. Strangers devour Your land in Your presence, and it is desolate, as if overthrown by strangers.
- 8 *And the daughter of Zion is left as a cottage in a vineyard, as a lodge in a garden of cucumbers, as a besieged city.* The daughter of Zion is left like a hut in a vineyard, like a shelter in a cucumber field, like a besieged city.
- 9 *Except the LORD of hosts had left unto us a very small remnant, we should have been as Sodom, and we should have been like unto Gomorrah.* Unless the LORD of hosts had left us a very small remnant, we would have been like Sodom, we would have been like Gomorrah.
- 10 *Hear the word of the LORD, ye rulers of Sodom; give ear unto the law of our God, ye people of Gomorrah.* Hear the word of the LORD, You rulers of Sodom! Listen to the law of our God, you people of Gomorrah!
- 11 *To what purpose is the multitude of your sacrifices unto me? saith the LORD: I am full of the burnt offerings of rams, and the fat of fed beasts; and I delight not in the blood of bullocks, or of lambs, or of he goats.* "What is the purpose of all Your sacrifices to Me?" says the LORD. "I am full of the burnt offerings of rams and the fat of fattened beasts. I do not delight in the blood of bulls, or of lambs, or of male goats.
- 12 *When ye come to appear before me, who hath required this at your hand, to tread my courts?* When You come to appear before Me, who has required this from Your hand, to trample My courts?

- 13 *Bring no more vain oblations; incense is an abomination unto me; the new moons and sabbaths, the calling of assemblies, I cannot away with; it is iniquity, even the solemn meeting.* Bring no more empty offerings; incense is detestable to Me. The new moons, the sabbaths, the calling of assemblies — I cannot endure iniquity together with the solemn meeting.
- 14 *Your new moons and your appointed feasts my soul hateth: they are a trouble unto me; I am weary to bear them.* My soul hates Your new moons and Your appointed feasts. They are a burden to Me; I am weary of bearing them.
- 15 *And when ye spread forth your hands, I will hide mine eyes from you: yea, when ye make many prayers, I will not hear: your hands are full of blood.* When You spread out Your hands, I will hide My eyes from You. Even though You make many prayers, I will not hear. Your hands are full of blood.
- 16 *Wash you, make you clean; put away the evil of your doings from before mine eyes; cease to do evil;* Wash yourselves; make yourselves clean. Put away the evil of Your doings from before My eyes. Stop doing evil.
- 17 *Learn to do well; seek judgment, relieve the oppressed, judge the fatherless, plead for the widow.* Learn to do good; seek justice, rebuke the oppressor, defend the fatherless, plead for the widow.
- 18 *Come now, and let us reason together, saith the LORD: though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they be red like crimson, they shall be as wool.* "Come now, let us reason together," says the LORD. "Though Your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red like crimson, they shall be as wool.
- 19 *If ye be willing and obedient, ye shall eat the good of the land:* If You are willing and obedient, You shall eat the good of the land;
- 20 *But if ye refuse and rebel, ye shall be devoured with the sword: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.* but if You refuse and rebel, You shall be devoured with the sword." For the mouth of the LORD has spoken.
- 21 *How is the faithful city become an harlot! it was full of judgment; righteousness lodged in it; but now murderers.* How the faithful city has become a harlot! It was full of justice; righteousness lodged in her — but now murderers.

- 22 *Thy silver is become dross, thy wine mixed with water:* Your silver has become dross, Your wine mixed with water.
- 23 *Thy princes are rebellious, and companions of thieves: every one loveth gifts, and followeth after rewards: they judge not the fatherless, neither doth the cause of the widow come unto them.* Your princes are rebellious and companions of thieves. Everyone loves bribes and chases after rewards. They do not defend the fatherless, and the cause of the widow does not come before them.
- 24 *Therefore saith the Lord, the LORD of hosts, the mighty One of Israel, Ah, I will ease me of mine adversaries, and avenge me of mine enemies:* Therefore the Lord, the LORD of hosts, the Mighty One of Israel, declares: "I will rid Myself of My adversaries and avenge Myself on My enemies.
- 25 *And I will turn my hand upon thee, and purely purge away thy dross, and take away all thy tin:* I will turn My hand against You and thoroughly purge away Your dross and remove all Your alloy.
- 26 *And I will restore thy judges as at the first, and thy counsellors as at the beginning: afterward thou shalt be called, The city of righteousness, the faithful city.* I will restore Your judges as at the first, and Your counselors as at the beginning. Afterward You shall be called the City of Righteousness, the Faithful City."
- 27 *Zion shall be redeemed with judgment, and her converts with righteousness.* Zion shall be redeemed with justice, and her penitents with righteousness.
- 28 *And the destruction of the transgressors and of the sinners shall be together, and they that forsake the LORD shall be consumed.* The destruction of the transgressors and of the sinners shall be together, and those who forsake the LORD shall be consumed.
- 29 *For they shall be ashamed of the oaks which ye have desired, and ye shall be confounded for the gardens that ye have chosen.* They shall be ashamed of the oaks You have desired, and You shall be embarrassed because of the gardens You have chosen.

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| 30 | <i>For ye shall be as an oak whose leaf
fadeth, and as a garden that hath no
water.</i> | For You shall be like an oak whose
leaf fades, and like a garden that has no
water. |
| 31 | <i>And the strong shall be as tow, and
the maker of it as a spark, and they
shall both burn together, and none
shall quench them.</i> | The strong shall be like tinder, and His
work like a spark; they shall both burn
together, and no one shall quench
them. |

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Gomorraah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 32:1; Deut 30:19; Mic 1:2; Deut 4:26; Ps 50:4
- v3 — Jer 8:7; Jer 4:22; Isa 44:18; Matt 13:13-15; Isa 5:12
- v8 — Zech 9:9; John 12:15; Zech 2:10; Isa 62:11; Isa 10:32
- v9 — Rom 9:29; Isa 37:31-32; Gen 19:24; Lam 3:22
- v10 — Isa 3:9; Rev 11:8; Deut 32:32; Ezek 16:49; Gen 13:13
- v11 — 1 Sam 15:22; Amos 5:21; Jer 6:20; Isa 66:3; Mic 6:7
- v13 — Isa 66:3; Mal 1:10; Matt 15:9; Ezek 20:39
- v15 — Mic 3:4; Prov 1:28; Isa 59:2-3; Zech 7:13; Jer 7:8-10
- v16 — 1 Pet 3:11; Isa 55:6-7; 1 Pet 2:1; 2 Cor 7:1; Jas 4:8
- v17 — Mic 6:8; Jer 22:3; Ps 82:3-4; Prov 31:9; Isa 1:23
- v18 — Isa 44:22; Rev 7:14; Ps 51:7; Mic 7:18-19; Isa 43:24-26
- v19 — Deut 30:15-16; Isa 3:10; Joel 2:26; Heb 5:9; Isa 55:6-7

Chapter 2

Isaiah prophesies that in the last days the mountain of the LORD's house will be exalted above the hills and all nations will flow to it. The LORD will judge among the nations and they will beat their swords into plowshares. He warns that the day of the LORD will bring low every proud and lofty thing.

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| 1 | <i>The word that Isaiah the son of Amoz saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem.</i> | The word that Isaiah the son of Amoz saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem. |
| 2 | <i>And it shall come to pass in the last days, that the mountain of the LORD's house shall be established in the top of the mountains, and shall be exalted above the hills; and all nations shall flow unto it.</i> | In the last days the mountain of the LORD's house shall be established on the highest of the mountains, exalted above the hills. All nations shall flow to it. |
| 3 | <i>And many people shall go and say, Come ye, and let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths: for out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.</i> | Many peoples shall come and say, "Come, let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob. He will teach us his ways, and we will walk in His paths." For out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem. |
| 4 | <i>And he shall judge among the nations, and shall rebuke many people: and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.</i> | He shall judge among the nations and rebuke many peoples. They shall beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation shall not lift up sword against nation; they shall not learn war anymore. |
| 5 | <i>O house of Jacob, come ye, and let us walk in the light of the LORD.</i> | O house of Jacob, come, let us walk in the light of the LORD. |

- 6 *Therefore thou hast forsaken thy people the house of Jacob, because they be replenished from the east, and are soothsayers like the Philistines, and they please themselves in the children of strangers.* You have forsaken Your people, the house of Jacob, because they are filled with customs from the east. They are soothsayers like the Philistines, and they strike hands with foreigners.
- 7 *Their land also is full of silver and gold, neither is there any end of their treasures; their land is also full of horses, neither is there any end of their chariots:* Their land is full of silver and gold; there is no end to their treasures. Their land is full of horses; there is no end to their chariots.
- 8 *Their land also is full of idols; they worship the work of their own hands, that which their own fingers have made:* Their land is full of idols. They worship the work of their own hands, what their own fingers have made.
- 9 *And the mean man boweth down, and the great man humbleth himself: therefore forgive them not.* The lowly man bows down, and the great man humbles himself — so do not forgive them.
- 10 *Enter into the rock, and hide thee in the dust, for fear of the LORD, and for the glory of his majesty.* Hide in the rock; take cover in the dust, from the terror of the LORD and the glory of His majesty.
- 11 *The lofty looks of man shall be humbled, and the haughtiness of men shall be bowed down, and the LORD alone shall be exalted in that day.* The proud looks of man shall be humbled, and the haughtiness of men bowed down. The LORD alone shall be exalted in that day.
- 12 *For the day of the LORD of hosts shall be upon every one that is proud and lofty, and upon every one that is lifted up; and he shall be brought low:* He shall be brought low —
- 13 *And upon all the cedars of Lebanon, that are high and lifted up, and upon all the oaks of Bashan,* against all the cedars of Lebanon that are high and lifted up, and against all the oaks of Bashan,
- 14 *And upon all the high mountains, and upon all the hills that are lifted up,* against all the high mountains, and against all the hills that are lifted up,

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| 15 | <i>And upon every high tower, and upon every fenced wall,</i> | against every high tower and every fortified wall, |
| 16 | <i>And upon all the ships of Tarshish, and upon all pleasant pictures.</i> | against all the ships of Tarshish and all the beautiful vessels. |
| 17 | <i>And the loftiness of man shall be bowed down, and the haughtiness of men shall be made low: and the LORD alone shall be exalted in that day.</i> | The loftiness of man shall be bowed down, and the haughtiness of men made low. The LORD alone shall be exalted in that day. |
| 18 | <i>And the idols he shall utterly abolish.</i> | He shall utterly abolish the idols. |
| 19 | <i>And they shall go into the holes of the rocks, and into the caves of the earth, for fear of the LORD, and for the glory of his majesty, when he ariseth to shake terribly the earth.</i> | People shall go into the holes of the rocks and into the caves of the earth, from the terror of the LORD and the glory of His majesty, when He rises to shake the earth terribly. |
| 20 | <i>In that day a man shall cast his idols of silver, and his idols of gold, which they made each one for himself to worship, to the moles and to the bats;</i> | In that day a man shall throw away his idols of silver and his idols of gold — which He made for Himself to worship — to the moles and to the bats, |
| 21 | <i>To go into the clefts of the rocks, and into the tops of the ragged rocks, for fear of the LORD, and for the glory of his majesty, when he ariseth to shake terribly the earth.</i> | to flee into the clefts of the rocks and the crags, from the terror of the LORD and the glory of His majesty, when He rises to shake the earth terribly. |
| 22 | <i>Cease ye from man, whose breath is in his nostrils: for wherein is he to be accounted of?</i> | Stop trusting in man, whose breath is in his nostrils. What is He worth? |

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Bashan (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 1:1
- v2 — Mic 4:1-3; Isa 56:7; Zech 8:3; Rev 11:15; Isa 27:13
- v3 — Jer 50:4-5; Luke 24:47; Zech 8:20-23; Isa 51:4-5; Ps 110:2
- v4 — Hos 2:18; Mic 4:3; Isa 11:6-9; Zech 9:10; Isa 60:17-18
- v5 — Eph 5:8; Isa 60:19-20; Luke 1:79; 1 John 1:7
- v8 — Ps 115:4-8
- v10 — Rev 6:15-16; Isa 2:19-21; Hos 10:8; Luke 23:30
- v11 — Isa 5:15-16; Ps 18:27; Isa 2:17; Mal 4:1; Isa 13:11
- v17 — Jer 48:29-30; Isa 2:11
- v19 — Isa 2:10; Luke 23:30; Isa 2:21; Hos 10:8
- v21 — Isa 2:19
- v22 — Jer 17:5; Ps 146:3; Jas 4:14; Ps 144:3-4; Ps 8:4

Chapter 3

The LORD declares He will remove from Jerusalem every supply and stay -- the mighty man, the judge, the prophet, and the elder. Children will rule over them and the people will oppress one another. The daughters of Zion are warned that their finery will be replaced with sackcloth and shame.

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| 1 | <i>For, behold, the Lord, the LORD of hosts, doth take away from Jerusalem and from Judah the stay and the staff, the whole stay of bread, and the whole stay of water,</i> | The Lord, the LORD of hosts, is removing from Jerusalem and from Judah all support — the entire supply of bread and the entire supply of water — |
| 2 | <i>The mighty man, and the man of war, the judge, and the prophet, and the prudent, and the ancient,</i> | the mighty man, the man of war, the judge, the prophet, the diviner, and the elder, |
| 3 | <i>The captain of fifty, and the honourable man, and the counsellor, and the cunning artificer, and the eloquent orator.</i> | the captain of fifty, the man of rank, the counselor, the skilled craftsman, and the eloquent speaker. |

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| 4 | <i>And I will give children to be their princes, and babes shall rule over them.</i> | "I will give them children as their princes, and infants shall rule over them. |
| 5 | <i>And the people shall be oppressed, every one by another, and every one by his neighbour: the child shall behave himself proudly against the ancient, and the base against the honourable.</i> | The people shall oppress one another — each man his neighbor. The young shall act arrogantly against the elder, and the lowly against the honorable." |
| 6 | <i>When a man shall take hold of his brother of the house of his father, saying, Thou hast clothing, be thou our ruler, and let this ruin be under thy hand:</i> | When a man grabs his brother in his father's house and says, "You have a coat — you be our ruler! Let this ruin be under your hand," |
| 7 | <i>In that day shall he swear, saying, I will not be an healer; for in my house is neither bread nor clothing: make me not a ruler of the people.</i> | in that day he will protest: "I will not be a healer. In my house there is neither bread nor coat. Do not make me ruler of the people." |
| 8 | <i>For Jerusalem is ruined, and Judah is fallen: because their tongue and their doings are against the LORD, to provoke the eyes of his glory.</i> | Jerusalem has stumbled, and Judah has fallen, because their speech and their deeds are against the LORD, provoking His glorious presence. |
| 9 | <i>The shew of their countenance doth witness against them; and they declare their sin as Sodom, they hide it not. Woe unto their soul! for they have rewarded evil unto themselves.</i> | The look on their faces testifies against them. They declare their sin like Sodom and do not hide it. Woe to them, for they have brought disaster on themselves! |
| 10 | <i>Say ye to the righteous, that it shall be well with him: for they shall eat the fruit of their doings.</i> | Tell the righteous that it will go well with them, for they shall eat the fruit of their deeds. |
| 11 | <i>Woe unto the wicked! it shall be ill with him: for the reward of his hands shall be given him.</i> | Woe to the wicked! It will go badly for them, for what their hands have done will be done to them. |

- 12 *As for my people, children are their oppressors, and women rule over them. O my people, they which lead thee cause thee to err, and destroy the way of thy paths.* As for My people, children oppress them, and women rule over them. O My people, your guides lead you astray and confuse the direction of your paths.
- 13 *The LORD standeth up to plead, and standeth to judge the people.* The LORD rises to argue His case; He stands to judge the peoples.
- 14 *The LORD will enter into judgment with the ancients of his people, and the princes thereof: for ye have eaten up the vineyard; the spoil of the poor is in your houses.* The LORD enters into judgment with the elders and princes of His people: "You have devoured the vineyard. The plunder of the poor is in Your houses.
- 15 *What mean ye that ye beat my people to pieces, and grind the faces of the poor? saith the Lord GOD of hosts.* What do You mean by crushing My people and grinding the faces of the poor?" declares the Lord GOD of hosts.
- 16 *Moreover the LORD saith, Because the daughters of Zion are haughty, and walk with stretched forth necks and wanton eyes, walking and mincing as they go, and making a tinkling with their feet:* The LORD also says: "Because the daughters of Zion are proud and walk with their necks stretched out and their eyes flirting, strutting and mincing as they go, with jingling ornaments on their feet,
- 17 *Therefore the Lord will smite with a scab the crown of the head of the daughters of Zion, and the LORD will discover their secret parts.* therefore the Lord will strike the scalp of the daughters of Zion with sores, and the LORD will lay their foreheads bare."
- 18 *In that day the Lord will take away the bravery of their tinkling ornaments about their feet, and their cauls, and their round tires like the moon,* In that day the Lord will take away the finery of their ankle chains, their headbands, and their crescent necklaces,
- 19 *The chains, and the bracelets, and the mufflers,* the pendants, the bracelets, and the veils,

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| 20 | <i>The bonnets, and the ornaments of the legs, and the headbands, and the tablets, and the earrings,</i> | the headdresses, the leg ornaments, the sashes, the perfume boxes, and the amulets, |
| 21 | <i>The rings, and nose jewels,</i> | the rings and the nose jewels, |
| 22 | <i>The changeable suits of apparel, and the mantles, and the wimples, and the crisping pins,</i> | the fine robes, the cloaks, the shawls, and the handbags, |
| 23 | <i>The glasses, and the fine linen, and the hoods, and the veils.</i> | the mirrors, the fine linen garments, the turbans, and the long veils. |
| 24 | <i>And it shall come to pass, that instead of sweet smell there shall be stink; and instead of a girdle a rent; and instead of well set hair baldness; and instead of a stomacher a girding of sackcloth; and burning instead of beauty.</i> | Instead of sweet perfume there will be a stench. Instead of a sash, a rope. Instead of styled hair, baldness. Instead of a rich robe, a garment of sackcloth. And a brand instead of beauty. |
| 25 | <i>Thy men shall fall by the sword, and thy mighty in the war.</i> | Your men shall fall by the sword and Your warriors in battle. |
| 26 | <i>And her gates shall lament and mourn; and she being desolate shall sit upon the ground.</i> | Her gates shall mourn and grieve, and she shall sit desolate on the ground. |

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Cross-References:

v1 — Lev 26:26

v4 — Eccl 10:16

v6 — Isa 4:1

v9 — Gen 13:13

v10 — Ps 128:1-2; Heb 6:10; Gal 6:7-8; Eccl 8:12; Ezek 18:9-19

v11 — Eccl 8:13; Jas 2:13; Ps 120:3-4; Ps 28:4; Isa 48:22

v12 — Isa 3:4; Nah 3:13

v16 — Isa 32:9-11; Ezek 16:49-50; Prov 30:13; Isa 4:4; Luke 23:28

v18 — Judg 8:21

v21 — Gen 24:47

v24 — Lam 2:10; Ezek 27:31; Mic 1:16; 1 Pet 3:3; Isa 22:12

v26 — Lam 2:10; Jer 14:2

Chapter 4

Isaiah prophesies that in that day seven women will take hold of one man. The Branch of the LORD will be beautiful and glorious for the survivors of Israel, and the LORD will create over Mount Zion a cloud by day and a fire by night as a covering of glory.

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| 1 | <i>And in that day seven women shall take hold of one man, saying, We will eat our own bread, and wear our own apparel: only let us be called by thy name, to take away our reproach.</i> | In that day seven women shall take hold of one man, saying, "We will eat our own bread and wear our own clothes — only let us be called by Your name; take away our shame." |
| 2 | <i>In that day shall the branch of the LORD be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the earth shall be excellent and comely for them that are escaped of Israel.</i> | In that day the Branch of the LORD shall be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the land shall be the pride and glory of the survivors of Israel. |
| 3 | <i>And it shall come to pass, that he that is left in Zion, and he that remaineth in Jerusalem, shall be called holy, even every one that is written among the living in Jerusalem:</i> | It shall come to pass that He who is left in Zion and remains in Jerusalem shall be called holy — everyone recorded among the living in Jerusalem — |
| 4 | <i>When the Lord shall have washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion, and shall have purged the blood of Jerusalem from the midst thereof by the spirit of judgment, and by the spirit of burning.</i> | when the Lord has washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion and cleansed the bloodstains of Jerusalem from its midst by a spirit of judgment and by a spirit of burning. |
| 5 | <i>And the LORD will create upon every dwelling place of mount Zion, and upon her assemblies, a cloud and smoke by day, and the shining of a flaming fire by night: for upon all the glory shall be a defence.</i> | Then the LORD will create over every home on Mount Zion and over her assemblies a cloud of smoke by day and a bright flame of fire by night. Over all the glory there will be a canopy. |

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| 6 | <i>And there shall be a tabernacle for a shadow in the daytime from the heat, and for a place of refuge and for a covert from storm and from rain.</i> | There shall be a shelter for shade from the heat by day, and a refuge and hiding place from the storm and rain. |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 30:23; Isa 2:17; Isa 13:12; Luke 1:25; Luke 21:22
v2 — Jer 23:5; Zech 6:12; Zech 3:8; Isa 27:6; Joel 2:32
v3 — Luke 10:20; Ex 32:32-33; Rev 21:27; Isa 60:21; Ps 69:28
v4 — Mal 3:2-3; Ezek 22:18-22; Zech 13:9; Ezek 36:25; Matt 3:11-12
v5 — Ex 13:21-22; Neh 9:12; Ex 40:34-38; Num 9:15-22; Ps 78:14
v6 — Isa 25:4; Ps 27:5; Isa 32:2

Chapter 5

Isaiah sings the parable of the LORD's vineyard, which He planted and tended but which yielded only wild grapes. The LORD pronounces six woes -- against those who join house to house, who rise early to follow strong drink, who call evil good and good evil, who are wise in their own eyes, and who justify the wicked for a bribe.

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| 1 | <i>Now will I sing to my wellbeloved a song of my beloved touching his vineyard. My wellbeloved hath a vineyard in a very fruitful hill:</i> | Let me sing for my beloved a love song about his vineyard. My beloved had a vineyard on a very fertile hill. |
| 2 | <i>And he fenced it, and gathered out the stones thereof, and planted it with the choicest vine, and built a tower in the midst of it, and also made a winepress therein: and he looked that it should bring forth grapes, and it brought forth wild grapes.</i> | He dug it up and cleared it of stones, and planted it with the choicest vines. He built a watchtower in the middle of it and cut out a wine vat. He expected it to yield good grapes — but it yielded wild grapes. |
| 3 | <i>And now, O inhabitants of Jerusalem, and men of Judah, judge, I pray you, betwixt me and my vineyard.</i> | "Now, O inhabitants of Jerusalem and men of Judah, judge between me and my vineyard. |

- 4 *What could have been done more to my vineyard, that I have not done in it? wherefore, when I looked that it should bring forth grapes, brought it forth wild grapes?* What more could have been done for my vineyard that I have not done? When I expected it to yield good grapes, why did it yield wild grapes?
- 5 *And now go to; I will tell you what I will do to my vineyard: I will take away the hedge thereof, and it shall be eaten up; and break down the wall thereof, and it shall be trodden down:* Now let me tell You what I will do to my vineyard. I will remove its hedge, and it shall be devoured. I will break down its wall, and it shall be trampled down.
- 6 *And I will lay it waste: it shall not be pruned, nor digged; but there shall come up briers and thorns: I will also command the clouds that they rain no rain upon it.* I will make it a wasteland — unpruned and unweeded — and briers and thorns shall come up. I will also command the clouds to rain no rain on it."
- 7 *For the vineyard of the LORD of hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah his pleasant plant: and he looked for judgment, but behold oppression; for righteousness, but behold a cry.* For the vineyard of the LORD of hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah are His pleasant planting. He looked for justice, but found bloodshed; for righteousness, but heard a cry of distress.
- 8 *Woe unto them that join house to house, that lay field to field, till there be no place, that they may be placed alone in the midst of the earth!* Woe to those who join house to house, who add field to field, until there is no room left, and You alone live in the midst of the land!
- 9 *In mine ears said the LORD of hosts, Of a truth many houses shall be desolate, even great and fair, without inhabitant.* The LORD of hosts said in my hearing, "Many houses shall be desolate — great and fine ones, with no one living in them."
- 10 *Yea, ten acres of vineyard shall yield one bath, and the seed of an homer shall yield an ephah.* Ten acres of vineyard shall produce only one bath of wine, and a homer of seed shall yield only an ephah of grain.

- 11 *Woe unto them that rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink; that continue until night, till wine inflame them!* Woe to those who rise early in the morning to run after strong drink, who stay up late into the night until wine inflames them!
- 12 *And the harp, and the viol, the tabret, and pipe, and wine, are in their feasts: but they regard not the work of the LORD, neither consider the operation of his hands.* They have lyre and harp, tambourine and flute, and wine at their feasts — but they do not regard the work of the LORD, nor consider what His hands have done.
- 13 *Therefore my people are gone into captivity, because they have no knowledge: and their honourable men are famished, and their multitude dried up with thirst.* Therefore My people go into captivity for lack of knowledge. Their honored men are starving and their crowd is parched with thirst.
- 14 *Therefore hell hath enlarged herself, and opened her mouth without measure: and their glory, and their multitude, and their pomp, and he that rejoiceth, shall descend into it.* Therefore hell has enlarged its appetite and opened its mouth beyond measure. Their glory, their crowd, their pomp, and all who rejoice among them descend into it.
- 15 *And the mean man shall be brought down, and the mighty man shall be humbled, and the eyes of the lofty shall be humbled:* The lowly shall be brought down, the mighty humbled, and the eyes of the proud brought low.
- 16 *But the LORD of hosts shall be exalted in judgment, and God that is holy shall be sanctified in righteousness.* But the LORD of hosts is exalted in justice, and God the Holy One shows Himself holy in righteousness.
- 17 *Then shall the lambs feed after their manner, and the waste places of the fat ones shall strangers eat.* Then lambs shall graze as in their pasture, and strangers shall eat among the ruins of the rich.
- 18 *Woe unto them that draw iniquity with cords of vanity, and sin as it were with a cart rope:* Woe to those who drag iniquity along with cords of deceit, and sin as if pulling it with a cart rope,

- 19 *That say, Let him make speed, and hasten his work, that we may see it: and let the counsel of the Holy One of Israel draw nigh and come, that we may know it!* who say, "Let Him hurry and hasten His work so we can see it! Let the plan of the Holy One of Israel draw near and come so we can know it!"
- 20 *Woe unto them that call evil good, and good evil; that put darkness for light, and light for darkness; that put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter!* Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, who put darkness for light and light for darkness, who put bitter for sweet and sweet for bitter!
- 21 *Woe unto them that are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight!* Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes and clever in their own sight!
- 22 *Woe unto them that are mighty to drink wine, and men of strength to mingle strong drink:* Woe to those who are heroes at drinking wine, champions at mixing strong drink,
- 23 *Which justify the wicked for reward, and take away the righteousness of the righteous from him!* who acquit the guilty for a bribe and deny justice to the innocent!
- 24 *Therefore as the fire devoureth the stubble, and the flame consumeth the chaff, so their root shall be as rottenness, and their blossom shall go up as dust: because they have cast away the law of the LORD of hosts, and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel.* Therefore, as a flame devours stubble and dry grass collapses into the fire, their root shall rot and their blossom blow away as dust — because they have rejected the law of the LORD of hosts and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel.
- 25 *Therefore is the anger of the LORD kindled against his people, and he hath stretched forth his hand against them, and hath smitten them: and the hills did tremble, and their carcasses were torn in the midst of the streets. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.* Therefore the anger of the LORD burned against His people. He stretched out His hand against them and struck them. The mountains trembled, and their corpses lay like refuse in the streets. Yet for all this His anger has not turned away; His hand is still stretched out.

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| <p>26 <i>And he will lift up an ensign to the nations from far, and will hiss unto them from the end of the earth: and, behold, they shall come with speed swiftly:</i></p> <p>27 <i>None shall be weary nor stumble among them; none shall slumber nor sleep; neither shall the girdle of their loins be loosed, nor the latchet of their shoes be broken:</i></p> <p>28 <i>Whose arrows are sharp, and all their bows bent, their horses' hoofs shall be counted like flint, and their wheels like a whirlwind:</i></p> <p>29 <i>Their roaring shall be like a lion, they shall roar like young lions: yea, they shall roar, and lay hold of the prey, and shall carry it away safe, and none shall deliver it.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And in that day they shall roar against them like the roaring of the sea: and if one look unto the land, behold darkness and sorrow, and the light is darkened in the heavens thereof.</i></p> | <p>He raises an ensign for distant nations and whistles for them from the ends of the earth. They come quickly, with great speed.</p> <p>None among them is weary or stumbles. None slumbers or sleeps. Their belts are not loosened; their sandal straps are not broken.</p> <p>Their arrows are sharp and their bows strung. Their horses' hooves are like flint, and their chariot wheels like a whirlwind.</p> <p>Their roaring is like a lion; they roar like young lions. They growl, seize the prey, and carry it off, with no one to rescue it.</p> <p>In that day they shall roar over them like the roaring of the sea. If one looks to the land — darkness and distress. The light is darkened by the clouds.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Mark 12:1; Luke 20:9; John 15:1; Ps 80:8; Jer 2:21
v2 — Jer 2:21; Deut 32:32-33; 1 Cor 9:7; Luke 13:6-7; Mark 11:13
v8 — Mic 2:2; Hab 2:9-12; Jer 22:13-17
v11 — Prov 23:29-30; Rom 13:13; Prov 20:1; Isa 5:22; Eccl 10:16-17
v12 — Ps 28:5; Job 21:11-14; Job 34:27; Amos 6:4-6
v14 — Luke 21:34; Hab 2:5; Prov 30:16; Ps 55:15; Matt 7:13
v16 — Ps 46:10; 1 Chr 29:11; Isa 12:4; Ezek 36:23; Isa 29:23

v20 — Prov 17:15; 2 Tim 3:1-5; Luke 16:15; Mal 2:17; Job 17:12

v21 — 1 Cor 3:18-20; Prov 3:7; Rom 12:16; Prov 26:12; Prov 26:16

v22 — Isa 5:11; Hab 2:15; Isa 28:7; Prov 23:19-20; Isa 56:12

v25 — Isa 9:21; Isa 10:4; 2 Kgs 9:37; Isa 9:17; Jer 4:24

v26 — Zech 10:8; Deut 28:49; Isa 7:18; Isa 18:3

Chapter 6

Isaiah sees the Lord sitting on His throne, high and lifted up, with the seraphim crying, 'Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts.' Isaiah cries out that he is undone as a man of unclean lips. A seraph touches his lips with a live coal from the altar, and the LORD commissions him to preach to a people who will hear but not understand.

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| <p>1 <i>In the year that king Uzziah died I saw also the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up, and his train filled the temple.</i></p> | <p>In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up, and the train of His robe filled the temple.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly.</i></p> | <p>Above Him stood the seraphim. Each had six wings: with two he covered his face, with two he covered his feet, and with two he flew.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And one cried unto another, and said, Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of hosts: the whole earth is full of his glory.</i></p> | <p>One called to another and said, "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; the whole earth is full of His glory!"</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And the posts of the door moved at the voice of him that cried, and the house was filled with smoke.</i></p> | <p>The foundations of the thresholds shook at the voice of Him who called, and the house was filled with smoke.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Then said I, Woe is me! for I am undone; because I am a man of unclean lips, and I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips: for mine eyes have seen the King, the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>I said, "Woe is me! I am ruined, for I am a man of unclean lips, and I live among a people of unclean lips — yet my eyes have seen the King, the LORD of hosts!"</p> |

- 6 *Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar:* Then one of the seraphim flew to me with a burning coal in His hand, which He had taken from the altar with tongs.
- 7 *And he laid it upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thine iniquity is taken away, and thy sin purged.* He touched my mouth with it and said, "This has touched Your lips; Your iniquity is taken away and Your sin purged."
- 8 *Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying, Whom shall I send, and who will go for us? Then said I, Here am I; send me.* I heard the voice of the Lord saying, "Whom shall I send, and who will go for Us?" I said, "Here I am. Send me."
- 9 *And he said, Go, and tell this people, Hear ye indeed, but understand not; and see ye indeed, but perceive not.* He said, "Go, and tell this people: 'Keep listening, but do not understand. Keep looking, but do not see.'"
- 10 *Make the heart of this people fat, and make their ears heavy, and shut their eyes; lest they see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and convert, and be healed.* Make the heart of this people dull, make their ears heavy, and shut their eyes — lest they see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their heart, and turn and be healed."
- 11 *Then said I, Lord, how long? And he answered, Until the cities be wasted without inhabitant, and the houses without man, and the land be utterly desolate,* I said, "Lord, how long?" He answered, "Until cities lie waste without inhabitant, and houses without man, and the land is utterly desolate,
- 12 *And the LORD have removed men far away, and there be a great forsaking in the midst of the land.* and the LORD has removed people far away, and the forsaken places are many in the midst of the land.
- 13 *But yet in it shall be a tenth, and it shall return, and shall be eaten: as a teil tree, and as an oak, whose substance is in them, when they cast their leaves: so the holy seed shall be the substance thereof.* Yet a tenth shall remain in it, and it will be burned again, like a terebinth or an oak whose stump remains when it is felled. The holy seed is its stump."

Words in this chapter:

seraphim (*SEHR-ah-fim*) — Fiery angelic beings seen in Isaiah's vision of God's throne — they had six wings and cried 'Holy, holy, holy'; their name means 'burning ones.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 12:41; Rev 15:8; Rev 7:15-17; Ps 113:5; Dan 7:9
- v2 — Rev 4:8; Ezek 1:11; Ps 104:4; Ps 103:20
- v3 — Rev 4:8-9; Ps 72:19; Ex 15:11; Ezra 3:11; Num 14:21
- v4 — Rev 15:8
- v5 — Luke 5:8-9; Jas 3:6-10; Jer 9:3-8; Jer 1:6; Matt 12:34-37
- v6 — Rev 8:3-5; Heb 9:22-26; Ezek 10:2
- v7 — Jer 1:9; 1 John 1:7; Isa 43:25; Dan 10:16
- v8 — Ex 4:10-13; Acts 26:16-17; Eph 3:8; Acts 22:21; Isa 65:1
- v9 — Matt 13:14-15; Luke 8:10; Mark 4:12; John 12:40; Acts 28:26-27
- v10 — Matt 13:15; Acts 28:27; Jer 5:21; Jer 6:10; John 3:19-20
- v12 — Jer 4:29
- v13 — Job 14:7-9; Rom 11:5-6; Gen 22:18; Isa 65:8-9; Rom 11:16-29

Chapter 7

The LORD sends Isaiah to King Ahaz during the Syro-Ephraimite crisis to tell him not to fear Rezin and Pekah. Ahaz refuses to ask for a sign, so the LORD gives one Himself: a virgin shall conceive and bear a son and call his name Immanuel. Before the child is old enough to know good from evil, both enemy kings will be forsaken.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass in the days of Ahaz the son of Jotham, the son of Uzziah, king of Judah, that Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, went up toward Jerusalem to war against it, but could not prevail against it.</i></p> | <p>In the days of Ahaz the son of Jotham, son of Uzziah, king of Judah, Rezin the king of Syria and Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, came up to Jerusalem to war against it, but could not defeat it.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it was told the house of David, saying, Syria is confederate with Ephraim. And his heart was moved, and the heart of his people, as the trees of the wood are moved with the wind.</i></p> | <p>When the house of David was told, "Syria is allied with Ephraim," the heart of Ahaz and the heart of his people shook as the trees of the forest shake before the wind.</p> |

- 3 *Then said the LORD unto Isaiah, Go forth now to meet Ahaz, thou, and Shearjashub thy son, at the end of the conduit of the upper pool in the highway of the fuller's field;* The LORD said to Isaiah, "Go out to meet Ahaz, you and your son Shearjashub, at the end of the conduit of the upper pool on the road to the field of the launderer.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Shearjashub** (sheer-JAY-shub) — "a remnant shall return" — Isaiah's son, whose name was itself a sign of God's promise to preserve a remnant of Israel.

- 4 *And say unto him, Take heed, and be quiet; fear not, neither be fainthearted for the two tails of these smoking firebrands, for the fierce anger of Rezin with Syria, and of the son of Remaliah.* Tell Him: 'Be careful, stay calm, and do not be afraid. Do not let Your heart grow faint because of these two smoldering stubs of torches — the fierce anger of Rezin and Syria and the son of Remaliah.
- 5 *Because Syria, Ephraim, and the son of Remaliah, have taken evil counsel against thee, saying,* Because Syria, with Ephraim and the son of Remaliah, has plotted evil against You, saying,
- 6 *Let us go up against Judah, and vex it, and let us make a breach therein for us, and set a king in the midst of it, even the son of Tabeal:* "Let us go up against Judah and terrify it, and let us conquer it for ourselves and set up the son of Tabeal as king in the midst of it" —
- 7 *Thus saith the Lord GOD, It shall not stand, neither shall it come to pass.* thus says the Lord GOD: It shall not stand, and it shall not come to pass.
- 8 *For the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin; and within threescore and five years shall Ephraim be broken, that it be not a people.* For the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin. Within sixty-five years Ephraim will be shattered so that it is no longer a people.
- 9 *And the head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is Remaliah's son. If ye will not believe, surely ye shall not be established.* The head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is Remaliah's son. If You will not believe, You will not be established.' "
- 10 *Moreover the LORD spake again unto Ahaz, saying,* The LORD spoke to Ahaz again, saying,

- 11 *Ask thee a sign of the LORD thy God; ask it either in the depth, or in the height above.* "Ask a sign of the LORD Your God — let it be as deep as the grave or as high as heaven."
- 12 *But Ahaz said, I will not ask, neither will I tempt the LORD.* But Ahaz said, "I will not ask, and I will not put the LORD to the test."
- 13 *And he said, Hear ye now, O house of David; Is it a small thing for you to weary men, but will ye weary my God also?* Isaiah said, "Hear then, O house of David! Is it too small a thing for you to weary men, that you must weary my God also?"
- 14 *Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.* Therefore the Lord Himself will give you a sign. A virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and shall call His name Immanuel.
- 15 *Butter and honey shall he eat, that he may know to refuse the evil, and choose the good.* He shall eat curds and honey when He knows to refuse the evil and choose the good.
- 16 *For before the child shall know to refuse the evil, and choose the good, the land that thou abhorrest shall be forsaken of both her kings.* For before the child knows to refuse the evil and choose the good, the land whose two kings you dread will be deserted.
- 17 *The LORD shall bring upon thee, and upon thy people, and upon thy father's house, days that have not come, from the day that Ephraim departed from Judah; even the king of Assyria.* The LORD will bring on You, on Your people, and on Your father's house, days such as have not come since the day that Ephraim departed from Judah — the king of Assyria."
- 18 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the LORD shall hiss for the fly that is in the uttermost part of the rivers of Egypt, and for the bee that is in the land of Assyria.* In that day the LORD will whistle for the fly that is in the far rivers of Egypt and for the bee that is in the land of Assyria.
- 19 *And they shall come, and shall all rest in the desolate valleys, and in the holes of the rocks, and upon all thorns, and upon all bushes.* They shall all come and settle in the steep ravines, and in the clefts of the rocks, and on all the thornbushes, and on all the watering holes.

- 20 *In the same day shall the Lord shave with a razor that is hired, namely, by them beyond the river, by the king of Assyria, the head, and the hair of the feet: and it shall also consume the beard.* In that day the Lord will shave with a hired razor — with those beyond the River, with the king of Assyria — the head and the hair of the legs. It will sweep away the beard also.
- 21 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that a man shall nourish a young cow, and two sheep;* In that day a man will keep alive a young cow and two sheep.
- 22 *And it shall come to pass, for the abundance of milk that they shall give he shall eat butter: for butter and honey shall every one eat that is left in the land.* Because of the abundance of milk they give, he shall eat curds. Everyone left in the land will eat curds and honey.
- 23 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that every place shall be, where there were a thousand vines at a thousand silverlings, it shall even be for briers and thorns.* In that day every place where there used to be a thousand vines worth a thousand pieces of silver shall become briers and thorns.
- 24 *With arrows and with bows shall men come thither; because all the land shall become briers and thorns.* Men will come there with bows and arrows, for all the land will be briers and thorns.
- 25 *And on all hills that shall be digged with the mattock, there shall not come thither the fear of briers and thorns: but it shall be for the sending forth of oxen, and for the treading of lesser cattle.* As for all the hills that used to be worked with a hoe, you will not go there for fear of briers and thorns. They will be places for oxen to roam and for sheep to trample.

Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Immanuel (*ih-MAN-yoo-el*) — Hebrew name meaning 'God with us' — the sign promised in Isaiah 7:14, fulfilled in the birth of Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Kgs 15:37; 2 Kgs 16:1
- v3 — Isa 36:2; 2 Kgs 18:17
- v4 — Isa 35:4; Lam 3:26; Deut 20:3; Isa 30:15; Matt 24:6
- v7 — Isa 8:10; Lam 3:37; Isa 46:10-11; Ps 33:11; Prov 21:30
- v9 — Heb 11:6; Rom 11:20; 2 Chr 20:20; 1 John 5:10; Acts 27:25
- v11 — Isa 37:30; Isa 38:7-8; 2 Kgs 19:29; Judg 6:36-40; Isa 38:22
- v13 — Isa 43:24
- v14 — Matt 1:23; Isa 9:6; Luke 1:31; John 1:1-2; John 1:14
- v15 — Isa 7:22
- v16 — Isa 8:4
- v18 — Isa 5:26
- v19 — Isa 2:19

Chapter 8

The LORD instructs Isaiah to write on a great tablet the name Mahershalalhashbaz, and Isaiah's wife bears a son by that name as a sign that Assyria will plunder Damascus and Samaria. Isaiah warns the people not to fear man but to sanctify the LORD as their fear. He and his children are for signs and wonders in Israel.

- 1

Moreover the LORD said unto me, Take thee a great roll, and write in it with a man's pen concerning Mahershalalhashbaz.
- The LORD said to me, "Take a large scroll and write on it in common script: Mahershalalhashbaz."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mahershalalhashbaz** (*MAY-her-SHAL-al-HASH-baz*) — "swift is the booty, speedy is the prey" — The name of Isaiah's son, given as a sign of the coming Assyrian conquest of Damascus and Samaria.

- 2

And I took unto me faithful witnesses to record, Uriah the priest, and Zechariah the son of Jeberechiah.
- I had it witnessed by Uriah the priest and Zechariah the son of Jeberechiah, reliable witnesses.
- 3

And I went unto the prophetess; and she conceived, and bare a son. Then said the LORD to me, Call his name Mahershalalhashbaz.
- I went to the prophetess, and she conceived and bore a son. The LORD said to me, "Call His name Mahershalalhashbaz."

- 4 *For before the child shall have knowledge to cry, My father, and my mother, the riches of Damascus and the spoil of Samaria shall be taken away before the king of Assyria.* For before the boy knows how to say 'My father' or 'My mother,' the wealth of Damascus and the plunder of Samaria shall be carried off before the king of Assyria."
- 5 *The LORD spake also unto me again, saying,* The LORD spoke to me again, saying,
- 6 *Forasmuch as this people refuseth the waters of Shiloah that go softly, and rejoice in Rezin and Remaliah's son;* "Because this people has rejected the waters of Shiloah that flow gently, and rejoice in Rezin and the son of Remaliah,
- 7 *Now therefore, behold, the Lord bringeth up upon them the waters of the river, strong and many, even the king of Assyria, and all his glory: and he shall come up over all his channels, and go over all his banks:* therefore the Lord is about to bring up against them the waters of the River — mighty and many — the king of Assyria and all his glory. It will rise over all its channels and overflow all its banks.
- 8 *And he shall pass through Judah; he shall overflow and go over, he shall reach even to the neck; and the stretching out of his wings shall fill the breadth of thy land, O Immanuel.* It shall sweep on into Judah, overflow, and pass through. It shall reach even to the neck, and its outspread wings shall fill the breadth of your land, O Immanuel."
- 9 *Associate yourselves, O ye people, and ye shall be broken in pieces; and give ear, all ye of far countries: gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces; gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces.* Band together, O peoples, and be shattered! Listen, all you distant lands. Prepare for battle, and be shattered! Prepare for battle, and be shattered!
- 10 *Take counsel together, and it shall come to nought; speak the word, and it shall not stand: for God is with us.* Devise a plan — it will come to nothing. State your case — it will not stand. For God is with us.
- 11 *For the LORD spake thus to me with a strong hand, and instructed me that I should not walk in the way of this people, saying,* For the LORD spoke to me with a strong hand and warned me not to walk in the way of this people, saying,

- 12 *Say ye not, A confederacy, to all them to whom this people shall say, A confederacy; neither fear ye their fear, nor be afraid.* "Do not call 'conspiracy' everything this people calls a conspiracy. Do not fear what they fear or be in dread of it.
- 13 *Sanctify the LORD of hosts himself; and let him be your fear, and let him be your dread.* The LORD of hosts — regard Him as holy. Let Him be Your fear and Your dread.
- 14 *And he shall be for a sanctuary; but for a stone of stumbling and for a rock of offence to both the houses of Israel, for a gin and for a snare to the inhabitants of Jerusalem.* He will be a sanctuary, but also a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense to both houses of Israel — a trap and a snare to the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
- 15 *And many among them shall stumble, and fall, and be broken, and be snared, and be taken.* Many shall stumble over it; they shall fall and be broken, be snared and taken."
- 16 *Bind up the testimony, seal the law among my disciples.* Bind up the testimony; seal the law among my disciples.
- 17 *And I will wait upon the LORD, that hideth his face from the house of Jacob, and I will look for him.* I will wait for the LORD, Who is hiding His face from the house of Jacob, and I will hope in him.
- 18 *Behold, I and the children whom the LORD hath given me are for signs and for wonders in Israel from the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth in mount Zion.* I and the children the LORD has given me are signs and wonders in Israel from the LORD of hosts, who dwells on Mount Zion.
- 19 *And when they shall say unto you, Seek unto them that have familiar spirits, and unto wizards that peep, and that mutter: should not a people seek unto their God? for the living to the dead?* When they say to You, "Seek those who have familiar spirits, and wizards that peep and mutter" — should not a people seek their God? Why consult the dead on behalf of the living?

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| <p>20 <i>To the law and to the testimony: if they speak not according to this word, it is because there is no light in them.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And they shall pass through it, hardly bestead and hungry: and it shall come to pass, that when they shall be hungry, they shall fret themselves, and curse their king and their God, and look upward.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And they shall look unto the earth; and behold trouble and darkness, dimness of anguish; and they shall be driven to darkness.</i></p> | <p>To the law and to the testimony! If they do not speak according to this word, it is because there is no light in them.</p> <p>They shall roam through the land, distressed and starving. When they are hungry, they will grow angry and curse their king and their God, looking upward.</p> <p>They shall look to the earth and see only distress, darkness, and the gloom of anguish. They are driven into thick darkness.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

familiar spirits — Demons or spirit-guides consulted by mediums and witches — strictly forbidden by God; communicating with them was punishable by death.

wizards — Those who practice magic or consult familiar spirits — KJV term for male practitioners of the occult; forbidden in Israel.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 30:8

v8 — Isa 7:14

v9 — Isa 14:5-6; Prov 11:21; 1 Kgs 20:11; Ps 37:14-15

v10 — Lam 3:37; Rom 8:31; Job 5:12; Prov 21:30; 2 Sam 15:31

v12 — 1 Pet 3:14-15; Luke 21:9; Ps 53:5; Isa 51:12-13; Luke 12:4-5

v13 — Luke 12:5; Rev 15:4; Isa 26:3-4; Matt 10:28; Ps 76:7

v14 — 1 Pet 2:8; Rom 9:32-33; Isa 28:16; Luke 2:34; Ezek 11:16

v17 — Heb 10:36-39; Hab 2:3; Lam 3:25-26; Isa 25:9; Ps 33:20

v18 — Heb 2:13-14; Luke 2:34; Zech 8:3; Isa 53:10; Ps 71:7

v19 — 1 Chr 10:13; Lev 20:6; 2 Chr 33:6; Ps 106:28; Lev 19:31

v20 — 2 Pet 1:19; Isa 30:8-11; 2 Tim 3:15-17; Ps 119:130; John 5:39

v22 — Isa 5:30

Chapter 9

Isaiah prophesies that the people who walked in darkness have seen a great light. A child is born whose name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace, and of His government and peace there shall be no end upon the throne of David. The LORD's anger against Israel is not yet turned away because the people do not repent.

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| 1 | <i>Nevertheless the dimness shall not be such as was in her vexation, when at the first he lightly afflicted the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali, and afterward did more grievously afflict her by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, in Galilee of the nations.</i> | But the gloom will not stay where there was distress. In the former time He treated the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali with contempt, but in the latter time He will make glorious the way of the sea, the land beyond the Jordan, Galilee of the nations. |
| 2 | <i>The people that walked in darkness have seen a great light: they that dwell in the land of the shadow of death, upon them hath the light shined.</i> | The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light. Those who lived in a land of deep darkness — a light has shone on them. |
| 3 | <i>Thou hast multiplied the nation, and not increased the joy: they joy before thee according to the joy in harvest, and as men rejoice when they divide the spoil.</i> | You have multiplied the nation and increased its joy. They rejoice before You as with joy at the harvest, as men are glad when they divide the plunder. |
| 4 | <i>For thou hast broken the yoke of his burden, and the staff of his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, as in the day of Midian.</i> | For the yoke of His burden, the staff on His shoulder, and the rod of His oppressor — You have broken these, as on the day of Midian. |
| 5 | <i>For every battle of the warrior is with confused noise, and garments rolled in blood; but this shall be with burning and fuel of fire.</i> | Every boot of the warrior in battle noise and every garment rolled in blood shall be burned as fuel for fire. |

- 6 *For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace.* For to us a Child is born, to us a Son is given. The government shall be on His shoulder, and His name shall be called Wonderful, Counselor, The Mighty God, The Everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace.
- 7 *Of the increase of his government and peace there shall be no end, upon the throne of David, and upon his kingdom, to order it, and to establish it with judgment and with justice from henceforth even for ever. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will perform this.* Of the increase of His government and of peace there shall be no end — on the throne of David and over his kingdom, to establish it and uphold it with justice and righteousness from this time forth and forever. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will accomplish this.
- 8 *The Lord sent a word into Jacob, and it hath lighted upon Israel.* The Lord has sent a word against Jacob, and it will fall on Israel.
- 9 *And all the people shall know, even Ephraim and the inhabitant of Samaria, that say in the pride and stoutness of heart,* All the people shall know — Ephraim and the inhabitants of Samaria — who say in pride and arrogance of heart,
- 10 *The bricks are fallen down, but we will build with hewn stones: the sycamores are cut down, but we will change them into cedars.* "The bricks have fallen, but we will rebuild with dressed stone. The sycamores have been cut down, but we will replace them with cedars."
- 11 *Therefore the LORD shall set up the adversaries of Rezin against him, and join his enemies together;* The LORD raises the adversaries of Rezin against them and stirs up their enemies —
- 12 *The Syrians before, and the Philistines behind; and they shall devour Israel with open mouth. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.* Syria on the east and Philistia on the west, and they devour Israel with open mouth. For all this His anger has not turned away; His hand is still stretched out.

- 13 *For the people turneth not unto him that smiteth them, neither do they seek the LORD of hosts.* Yet the people do not turn to him who struck them, nor seek the LORD of hosts.
- 14 *Therefore the LORD will cut off from Israel head and tail, branch and rush, in one day.* Therefore the LORD will cut off from Israel head and tail, palm branch and reed, in one day —
- 15 *The ancient and honourable, he is the head; and the prophet that teacheth lies, he is the tail.* the elder and honored man is the head, and the prophet who teaches lies is the tail.
- 16 *For the leaders of this people cause them to err; and they that are led of them are destroyed.* The leaders of this people lead them astray, and those they lead are swallowed up.
- 17 *Therefore the Lord shall have no joy in their young men, neither shall have mercy on their fatherless and widows: for every one is an hypocrite and an evildoer, and every mouth speaketh folly. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.* Therefore the Lord will not rejoice over their young men, nor have mercy on their fatherless and widows, for everyone is godless and wicked, and every mouth speaks foolishness. For all this His anger has not turned away; His hand is still stretched out.
- 18 *For wickedness burneth as the fire: it shall devour the briers and thorns, and shall kindle in the thickets of the forest, and they shall mount up like the lifting up of smoke.* For wickedness burns like a fire; it devours briers and thorns. It kindles in the thickets of the forest, and they roll upward in a column of smoke.
- 19 *Through the wrath of the LORD of hosts is the land darkened, and the people shall be as the fuel of the fire: no man shall spare his brother.* Through the wrath of the LORD of hosts the land is scorched, and the people are like fuel for the fire. No one spares his brother.
- 20 *And he shall snatch on the right hand, and be hungry; and he shall eat on the left hand, and they shall not be satisfied: they shall eat every man the flesh of his own arm:* They slice on the right and are still hungry; they devour on the left and are not satisfied. Each devours the flesh of His own arm —

- 21 *Manasseh, Ephraim; and Ephraim, Manasseh: and they together shall be against Judah. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.* Manasseh devours Ephraim, and Ephraim devours Manasseh; together they are against Judah. For all this His anger has not turned away; His hand is still stretched out.

Words in this chapter:

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Zebulun (*ZEB-yoo-lun*) — Jacob's tenth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the lowlands of Galilee; his name means 'honor' or 'exalted.'

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Philistia (*fiH-LIS-tee-ah*) — The coastal plain south of Canaan — home of the Philistines, Israel's persistent enemies; their five main cities were Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Gath, and Ekron.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 4:15-16; 2 Kgs 15:29; Isa 8:22
- v2 — Matt 4:16; Eph 5:8; John 8:12; John 12:46; Luke 1:78-79
- v3 — Ps 119:162; Isa 35:10; Isa 65:18; Isa 66:10; Isa 26:15
- v4 — Isa 14:25; Jer 30:8; Isa 10:26-27; Nah 1:13; Isa 54:14
- v5 — 2 Thess 1:8
- v6 — Luke 2:11; Matt 28:18; Jer 23:5-6; Isa 7:14; Matt 1:23
- v7 — Luke 1:32-33; Dan 2:44; Dan 7:14; Ps 45:4-6; 2 Sam 7:16
- v10 — Mal 1:4
- v12 — Isa 5:25; 2 Chr 28:18
- v16 — Matt 15:14; Isa 3:12
- v17 — Jer 18:21; Isa 10:6; Isa 5:25
- v20 — Isa 49:26

Chapter 10

The LORD pronounces woe on those who decree unrighteous decrees and rob the poor of their rights. He will use Assyria as the rod of His anger against Israel, but afterward He will punish the king of Assyria for his arrogance. A remnant of Israel will return and lean on the LORD in truth.

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| 1 <i>Woe unto them that decree
unrighteous decrees, and that write
grievousness which they have
prescribed;</i> | Woe to those who enact unjust laws
and issue oppressive rulings, |
| 2 <i>To turn aside the needy from
judgment, and to take away the right
from the poor of my people, that
widows may be their prey, and that
they may rob the fatherless!</i> | to deprive the poor of justice and rob
the needy among My people of their
rights — so that widows become their
prey and they plunder the fatherless! |
| 3 <i>And what will ye do in the day of
visitation, and in the desolation which
shall come from far? to whom will ye
flee for help? and where will ye leave
your glory?</i> | What will You do on the day of
punishment, when disaster comes from
afar? To whom will You flee for help?
Where will You leave Your wealth? |
| 4 <i>Without me they shall bow down
under the prisoners, and they shall
fall under the slain. For all this his
anger is not turned away, but his hand
is stretched out still.</i> | Nothing remains but to crouch among
the prisoners or fall among the slain.
For all this His anger has not turned
away; His hand is still stretched out. |
| 5 <i>O Assyrian, the rod of mine anger,
and the staff in their hand is mine
indignation.</i> | Woe to Assyria, the rod of My anger
— the staff in their hand is My fury! |
| 6 <i>I will send him against an hypocritical
nation, and against the people of my
wrath will I give him a charge, to take
the spoil, and to take the prey, and to
tread them down like the mire of the
streets.</i> | I send Him against a godless nation; I
command Him against the people of
My wrath, to plunder and to take the
spoil, and to trample them down like
mud in the streets. |
| 7 <i>Howbeit he meaneth not so, neither
doth his heart think so; but it is in his
heart to destroy and cut off nations
not a few.</i> | But He does not intend this, nor does
His heart think this way — his plan is
to destroy and cut off many nations. |
| 8 <i>For he saith, Are not my princes
altogether kings?</i> | For He says, "Are not all my
commanders kings?" |

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| <p>9 <i>Is not Calno as Carchemish? is not Hamath as Arpad? is not Samaria as Damascus?</i></p> <p>10 <i>As my hand hath found the kingdoms of the idols, and whose graven images did excel them of Jerusalem and of Samaria;</i></p> <p>11 <i>Shall I not, as I have done unto Samaria and her idols, so do to Jerusalem and her idols?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Wherefore it shall come to pass, that when the Lord hath performed his whole work upon mount Zion and on Jerusalem, I will punish the fruit of the stout heart of the king of Assyria, and the glory of his high looks.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For he saith, By the strength of my hand I have done it, and by my wisdom; for I am prudent: and I have removed the bounds of the people, and have robbed their treasures, and I have put down the inhabitants like a valiant man:</i></p> <p>14 <i>And my hand hath found as a nest the riches of the people: and as one gathereth eggs that are left, have I gathered all the earth; and there was none that moved the wing, or opened the mouth, or peeped.</i></p> | <p>Is not Calno like Carchemish? Is not Hamath like Arpad? Is not Samaria like Damascus?</p> <p>As my hand has reached the kingdoms of the idols, whose carved images were greater than those of Jerusalem and Samaria —</p> <p>shall I not do to Jerusalem and her idols what I did to Samaria and her idols?"</p> <p>When the Lord has finished all His work on Mount Zion and on Jerusalem, He will punish the boastful heart of the king of Assyria and his proud eyes.</p> <p>For he says, "By the strength of my hand I have done it, and by my wisdom, for I have understanding. I removed the boundaries of peoples, plundered their treasures, and like a warrior brought down those who sat on thrones."</p> <p>My hand found the wealth of the peoples as one finds a bird's nest. As one gathers abandoned eggs, I gathered all the earth. Not one wing fluttered, not a mouth opened, not a peep was heard."</p> |
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- 15 *Shall the axe boast itself against him that heweth therewith? or shall the saw magnify itself against him that shaketh it? as if the rod should shake itself against them that lift it up, or as if the staff should lift up itself, as if it were no wood.* Shall the axe boast over him who swings it? Shall the saw magnify itself against him who wields it? That would be like a rod wielding the one who lifts it — like a staff lifting up a man who is not wood!
- 16 *Therefore shall the Lord, the Lord of hosts, send among his fat ones leanness; and under his glory he shall kindle a burning like the burning of a fire.* Therefore the Lord, the LORD of hosts, will send wasting sickness among His stout warriors; under His glory a fire will be kindled, burning like a blazing flame.
- 17 *And the light of Israel shall be for a fire, and his Holy One for a flame: and it shall burn and devour his thorns and his briers in one day;* The Light of Israel shall become a fire, and His Holy One a flame. It shall burn and devour His thorns and briers in one day.
- 18 *And shall consume the glory of his forest, and of his fruitful field, both soul and body: and they shall be as when a standardbearer fainteth.* It will destroy the glory of His forest and His fruitful land, both soul and body, and it will be as when a sick man wastes away.
- 19 *And the rest of the trees of his forest shall be few, that a child may write them.* The remaining trees of His forest will be so few that a child could count them.
- 20 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the remnant of Israel, and such as are escaped of the house of Jacob, shall no more again stay upon him that smote them; but shall stay upon the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, in truth.* In that day the remnant of Israel and the survivors of the house of Jacob will no longer lean on him who struck them, but will truly lean on the LORD, the Holy One of Israel.
- 21 *The remnant shall return, even the remnant of Jacob, unto the mighty God.* A remnant shall return — the remnant of Jacob — to the Mighty God.

- 22 *For though thy people Israel be as the sand of the sea, yet a remnant of them shall return: the consumption decreed shall overflow with righteousness.* Though your people Israel be as the sand of the sea, only a remnant of them shall return. Destruction is decreed, overflowing with righteousness.
- 23 *For the Lord GOD of hosts shall make a consumption, even determined, in the midst of all the land.* For the Lord GOD of hosts will carry out a full destruction — as decreed — throughout the land.
- 24 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD of hosts, O my people that dwellest in Zion, be not afraid of the Assyrian: he shall smite thee with a rod, and shall lift up his staff against thee, after the manner of Egypt.* Therefore thus says the Lord GOD of hosts: O My people who live in Zion, do not be afraid of the Assyrian. He strikes you with the rod and lifts His staff against You as Egypt did.
- 25 *For yet a very little while, and the indignation shall cease, and mine anger in their destruction.* In just a little while My fury will be spent, and My anger will turn to their destruction.
- 26 *And the LORD of hosts shall stir up a scourge for him according to the slaughter of Midian at the rock of Oreb: and as his rod was upon the sea, so shall he lift it up after the manner of Egypt.* The LORD of hosts will brandish a whip against Him, as He struck Midian at the rock of Oreb. His staff will be over the sea, and He will lift it as He did in Egypt.
- 27 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that his burden shall be taken away from off thy shoulder, and his yoke from off thy neck, and the yoke shall be destroyed because of the anointing.* In that day His burden will depart from Your shoulder, and His yoke from Your neck. The yoke will be broken because You have grown fat.
- 28 *He is come to Aiath, he is passed to Migron; at Michmash he hath laid up his carriages:* He has come to Aiath; He has passed through Migron; at Michmash He stores His supplies.
- 29 *They are gone over the passage: they have taken up their lodging at Geba; Ramah is afraid; Gibeah of Saul is fled.* They have crossed the pass; at Geba they make their camp for the night. Ramah trembles; Gibeah of Saul has fled.

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| <p>30 <i>Lift up thy voice, O daughter of Gallim: cause it to be heard unto Laish, O poor Anathoth.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Madmenah is removed; the inhabitants of Gebim gather themselves to flee.</i></p> <p>32 <i>As yet shall he remain at Nob that day: he shall shake his hand against the mount of the daughter of Zion, the hill of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Behold, the Lord, the LORD of hosts, shall lop the bough with terror: and the high ones of stature shall be hewn down, and the haughty shall be humbled.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And he shall cut down the thickets of the forest with iron, and Lebanon shall fall by a mighty one.</i></p> | <p>Cry out, O daughter of Gallim! Listen, O Laishah! Answer her, O Anathoth!</p> <p>Madmenah is in flight; the inhabitants of Gebim seek refuge.</p> <p>This very day he halts at Nob; he shakes his fist at the mount of the daughter of Zion, the hill of Jerusalem.</p> <p>The Lord, the LORD of hosts, will lop off the boughs with terrifying power. The tall trees shall be cut down; the lofty shall be brought low.</p> <p>He will cut down the thickets of the forest with an axe, and Lebanon shall fall by the Mighty One.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Saul (SAWL) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 11:52; Mic 3:1-4; Ps 94:20-21; Matt 23:23
- v2 — Mal 3:5
- v3 — Luke 19:44; Hos 9:7; Job 31:14
- v6 — Isa 9:17
- v7 — Gen 50:20
- v9 — 2 Chr 35:20; 2 Kgs 16:9
- v12 — Jer 50:18
- v15 — Rom 9:20-21; Isa 45:9; Isa 10:5; Isa 29:16
- v21 — Isa 9:6
- v22 — Rom 9:27-28
- v26 — Isa 9:4; Judg 7:25
- v27 — Isa 9:4; Luke 4:18; Isa 14:25; Ps 105:15; 1 John 2:20

Chapter 11

Isaiah prophesies that a rod shall come forth from the stem of Jesse and a Branch shall grow out of his roots. The Spirit of the LORD shall rest upon Him, and He shall judge the poor with righteousness. The wolf shall dwell with the lamb, and the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the LORD as the waters cover the sea.

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| 1 <i>And there shall come forth a rod out of the stem of Jesse, and a Branch shall grow out of his roots:</i> | A shoot shall come from the stump of Jesse, and a Branch shall grow from His roots. |
| 2 <i>And the spirit of the LORD shall rest upon him, the spirit of wisdom and understanding, the spirit of counsel and might, the spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD;</i> | The Spirit of the LORD shall rest on Him — the Spirit of wisdom and understanding, the Spirit of counsel and might, the Spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD. |
| 3 <i>And shall make him of quick understanding in the fear of the LORD: and he shall not judge after the sight of his eyes, neither reprove after the hearing of his ears:</i> | His delight shall be in the fear of the LORD. He shall not judge by what His eyes see, nor decide by what His ears hear, |
| 4 <i>But with righteousness shall he judge the poor, and reprove with equity for the meek of the earth: and he shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked.</i> | but with righteousness He shall judge the poor, and decide with fairness for the meek of the earth. He shall strike the earth with the rod of His mouth, and with the breath of His lips He shall slay the wicked. |
| 5 <i>And righteousness shall be the girdle of his loins, and faithfulness the girdle of his reins.</i> | Righteousness shall be the belt of His waist, and faithfulness the belt of His hips. |
| 6 <i>The wolf also shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid; and the calf and the young lion and the fatling together; and a little child shall lead them.</i> | The wolf shall live with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the young goat. The calf, the young lion, and the fattened calf shall be together, and a little child shall lead them. |

- 7 *And the cow and the bear shall feed; their young ones shall lie down together: and the lion shall eat straw like the ox.* The cow and the bear shall graze together; their young shall lie down together. The lion shall eat straw like the ox.
- 8 *And the sucking child shall play on the hole of the asp, and the weaned child shall put his hand on the cockatrice' den.* The nursing child shall play over the hole of the cobra, and the weaned child shall put his hand on the adder's den.
- 9 *They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain: for the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.* They shall not hurt or destroy in all My holy mountain, for the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the LORD as the waters cover the sea.
- 10 *And in that day there shall be a root of Jesse, which shall stand for an ensign of the people; to it shall the Gentiles seek: and his rest shall be glorious.* In that day the Root of Jesse shall stand as an ensign for the peoples. The nations shall seek him, and his resting place shall be glorious.
- 11 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the Lord shall set his hand again the second time to recover the remnant of his people, which shall be left, from Assyria, and from Egypt, and from Pathros, and from Cush, and from Elam, and from Shinar, and from Hamath, and from the islands of the sea.* In that day the Lord shall reach out His hand a second time to recover the remnant of His people — from Assyria, Egypt, Pathros, Cush, Elam, Shinar, Hamath, and from the coastlands of the sea.
- 12 *And he shall set up an ensign for the nations, and shall assemble the outcasts of Israel, and gather together the dispersed of Judah from the four corners of the earth.* He shall set up an ensign for the nations and assemble the banished of Israel. He shall gather the scattered of Judah from the four corners of the earth.

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| <p>13 <i>The envy also of Ephraim shall depart, and the adversaries of Judah shall be cut off: Ephraim shall not envy Judah, and Judah shall not vex Ephraim.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But they shall fly upon the shoulders of the Philistines toward the west; they shall spoil them of the east together: they shall lay their hand upon Edom and Moab; and the children of Ammon shall obey them.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the LORD shall utterly destroy the tongue of the Egyptian sea; and with his mighty wind shall he shake his hand over the river, and shall smite it in the seven streams, and make men go over dryshod.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And there shall be an highway for the remnant of his people, which shall be left, from Assyria; like as it was to Israel in the day that he came up out of the land of Egypt.</i></p> | <p>The envy of Ephraim shall depart, and the enemies of Judah shall be cut off. Ephraim shall not envy Judah, and Judah shall not trouble Ephraim.</p> <p>They shall swoop down on the shoulder of the Philistines to the west; together they shall plunder the people of the east. They shall reach out their hands against Edom and Moab, and the Ammonites shall obey them.</p> <p>The LORD will dry up the tongue of the Sea of Egypt, and wave His hand over the River with His scorching breath. He will strike it into seven channels, and people will cross over on sandals.</p> <p>There shall be a highway for the remnant of His people remaining from Assyria — as there was for Israel on the day they came up out of Egypt.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

cockatrice (*KOK-ah-tris*) — KJV word for a deadly serpent (likely a viper or basilisk) — used in Isaiah 11:8 and 14:29 to describe venomous snakes; a symbol of deadly evil.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 23:5; Rev 22:16; Zech 6:12; Rev 5:5; Acts 13:22-23
v2 — Isa 61:1; John 16:13; Eph 1:17-18; 2 Tim 1:7; Isa 42:1
v3 — John 7:24; Luke 2:52; John 8:15-16; 1 Sam 16:7; 1 Cor 2:13-15
v4 — 2 Thess 2:8; Rev 19:15; Mal 4:6; Job 4:9; Prov 31:8-9
v6 — Isa 65:25; Hos 2:18; Ezek 34:25; Rev 5:9-10; Gal 3:26-27
v9 — Hab 2:14; Isa 52:10; Ps 98:2-3; Mic 4:2-4; Job 5:23
v10 — Rom 15:9-12; Luke 2:32; Isa 11:1; Matt 2:1-2; John 12:32
v11 — Mic 7:12; Zech 10:8-12; Isa 10:20; Hos 3:4-5; Rom 11:26
v12 — Isa 43:6; Isa 56:8; Zeph 3:10; Ps 147:2; Isa 11:10
v13 — Jer 3:18; Hos 1:11; Ezek 37:16-24
v15 — Zech 10:11; Rev 16:12; Isa 50:2; Isa 19:16; Isa 7:20
v16 — Isa 19:23; Isa 35:8-10; Isa 11:11

Chapter 12

Isaiah gives a song of praise for the day of salvation. The redeemed will say, 'O LORD, I will praise You; though You were angry with me, Your anger is turned away.' They will draw water with joy from the wells of salvation and declare the LORD's doings among the peoples.

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| <p>1 <i>And in that day thou shalt say, O LORD, I will praise thee: though thou wast angry with me, thine anger is turned away, and thou comfortedst me.</i></p> | <p>In that day You will say, "I will praise You, O LORD. Though You were angry with me, Your anger turned away, and You comforted me.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Behold, God is my salvation; I will trust, and not be afraid: for the LORD JEHOVAH is my strength and my song; he also is become my salvation.</i></p> | <p>God is my salvation; I will trust and not be afraid. For the LORD JEHOVAH is my strength and my song; He has become my salvation."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Therefore with joy shall ye draw water out of the wells of salvation.</i></p> | <p>With joy You will draw water from the wells of salvation.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And in that day shall ye say, Praise the LORD, call upon his name, declare his doings among the people, make mention that his name is exalted.</i></p> | <p>In that day You will say, "Give thanks to the LORD! Call upon His name. Make known His deeds among the peoples; declare that His name is exalted.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Sing unto the LORD; for he hath done excellent things: this is known in all the earth.</i></p> | <p>Sing to the LORD, for He has done glorious things. Let this be known throughout all the earth.</p> |

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| <p>6 Cry out and shout, thou inhabitant of Zion: for great is the Holy One of Israel in the midst of thee.</p> | <p>Shout and sing for joy, O inhabitant of Zion, for great in Your midst is the Holy One of Israel!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 30:5; Isa 54:8; Isa 25:1; Zech 14:9; Isa 40:1-2
v2 — Ex 15:2; Ps 118:14; Ps 27:1; Rev 7:10; Isa 26:3-4
v3 — Rev 22:1; Jer 2:13; Rev 22:17; John 4:10-14; Rev 7:17
v4 — Ps 105:1; Ps 145:4-6; 1 Chr 29:11; Ps 117:1-2; Phil 2:9-11
v5 — Ex 15:1; Ps 98:1
v6 — Zech 2:10-11; Zech 2:5; Zeph 3:14-17; Ps 9:11

Chapter 13

Isaiah pronounces the burden against Babylon. The LORD musters an army for the day of His wrath, which will come as destruction from the Almighty. Babylon, the glory of kingdoms, will be overthrown as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and will never be inhabited again.

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| <p>1 The burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz did see.</p> | <p>The burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz saw.</p> |
| <p>2 Lift ye up a banner upon the high mountain, exalt the voice unto them, shake the hand, that they may go into the gates of the nobles.</p> | <p>Lift up an ensign on the bare mountain; call out to them. Wave the hand so they may enter the gates of the nobles.</p> |
| <p>3 I have commanded my sanctified ones, I have also called my mighty ones for mine anger, even them that rejoice in my highness.</p> | <p>I have commanded My consecrated ones. I have summoned My warriors to carry out My anger — those who exult in My majesty.</p> |
| <p>4 The noise of a multitude in the mountains, like as of a great people; a tumultuous noise of the kingdoms of nations gathered together: the LORD of hosts mustereth the host of the battle.</p> | <p>A noise of a crowd on the mountains — like that of a great people! A tumult of kingdoms, of nations gathering! The LORD of hosts is mustering an army for battle.</p> |

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| 5 | <i>They come from a far country, from the end of heaven, even the LORD, and the weapons of his indignation, to destroy the whole land.</i> | They come from a far country, from the end of the heavens — the LORD and the weapons of His indignation — to destroy the whole land. |
| 6 | <i>Howl ye; for the day of the LORD is at hand; it shall come as a destruction from the Almighty.</i> | Wail, for the day of the LORD is near! It shall come as destruction from the Almighty. |
| 7 | <i>Therefore shall all hands be faint, and every man's heart shall melt:</i> | Therefore all hands shall grow faint and every man's heart melt. |
| 8 | <i>And they shall be afraid: pangs and sorrows shall take hold of them; they shall be in pain as a woman that travaileth: they shall be amazed one at another; their faces shall be as flames.</i> | They shall be terrified. Pangs and agony shall seize them. They shall writhe like a woman in labor. They shall look at one another in shock; their faces shall be ablaze. |
| 9 | <i>Behold, the day of the LORD cometh, cruel both with wrath and fierce anger, to lay the land desolate: and he shall destroy the sinners thereof out of it.</i> | The day of the LORD comes — cruel, with fury and burning anger — to make the land a desolation. He will destroy its sinners from it. |
| 10 | <i>For the stars of heaven and the constellations thereof shall not give their light: the sun shall be darkened in his going forth, and the moon shall not cause her light to shine.</i> | For the stars of heaven and their constellations shall not give their light. The sun shall be dark at its rising, and the moon shall not shine its light. |
| 11 | <i>And I will punish the world for their evil, and the wicked for their iniquity; and I will cause the arrogancy of the proud to cease, and will lay low the haughtiness of the terrible.</i> | I will punish the world for its evil and the wicked for their iniquity. I will put an end to the arrogance of the proud and lay low the haughtiness of the ruthless. |
| 12 | <i>I will make a man more precious than fine gold; even a man than the golden wedge of Ophir.</i> | I will make men scarcer than fine gold — rarer than the gold of Ophir. |

- 13 *Therefore I will shake the heavens, and the earth shall remove out of her place, in the wrath of the LORD of hosts, and in the day of his fierce anger.* Therefore I will shake the heavens, and the earth will move out of its place, at the wrath of the LORD of hosts and in the day of His fierce anger.
- 14 *And it shall be as the chased roe, and as a sheep that no man taketh up: they shall every man turn to his own people, and flee every one into his own land.* Like a hunted gazelle or a flock with no one to gather them, everyone shall turn to his own people and flee to His own land.
- 15 *Every one that is found shall be thrust through; and every one that is joined unto them shall fall by the sword.* Everyone who is found will be stabbed through; everyone who is caught will fall by the sword.
- 16 *Their children also shall be dashed to pieces before their eyes; their houses shall be spoiled, and their wives ravished.* Their infants shall be dashed to pieces before their eyes; their houses shall be plundered and their wives violated.
- 17 *Behold, I will stir up the Medes against them, which shall not regard silver; and as for gold, they shall not delight in it.* I am stirring up the Medes against them — they have no regard for silver and no delight in gold.
- 18 *Their bows also shall dash the young men to pieces; and they shall have no pity on the fruit of the womb; their eye shall not spare children.* Their bows shall cut down young men. They shall have no compassion on the fruit of the womb; their eyes shall not pity children.
- 19 *And Babylon, that glory of kingdoms, the beauty of the Chaldees' excellency, shall be as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah.* Babylon — the glory of kingdoms, the splendor and pride of the Chaldeans — shall be like Sodom and Gomorrah when God overthrew them.
- 20 *It shall never be inhabited, neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation: neither shall the Arabian pitch tent there; neither shall the shepherds make their fold there.* It shall never be inhabited or lived in from generation to generation. No Arab shall pitch a tent there; no shepherd shall rest his flock there.

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| <p>21 <i>But wild beasts of the desert shall lie there; and their houses shall be full of doleful creatures; and owls shall dwell there, and satyrs shall dance there.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the wild beasts of the islands shall cry in their desolate houses, and dragons in their pleasant palaces: and her time is near to come, and her days shall not be prolonged.</i></p> | <p>But wild beasts of the desert shall lie there, and their houses shall be full of doleful creatures. Owls shall dwell there, and satyrs shall dance there.</p> <p>The wild beasts of the islands shall cry in their desolate houses, and dragons in their pleasant palaces. Her time is near to come, and her days shall not be prolonged.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Isa 47:1-15; Jer 50:1-51:64; Isa 1:1
v2 — Isa 5:26; Jer 51:58; Jer 50:2; Isa 45:1-3; Jer 51:25
v6 — Joel 1:15; Ezek 30:2-3; Amos 5:18; Zeph 1:7; Isa 13:9
v9 — Mal 4:1; Nah 1:6; Isa 13:15-18; Isa 13:6
v10 — Joel 2:31; Matt 24:29; Mark 13:24; Ezek 32:7-8; Luke 21:25
v11 — Isa 2:11
v12 — Isa 4:1
v13 — Heb 12:26-27; Joel 3:16; Matt 24:29; Nah 1:4-6; Hag 2:6-7
v14 — Jer 50:16; 1 Kgs 22:17; 1 Kgs 22:36
v17 — Dan 5:28-31; Jer 51:11; Jer 51:27-28; Isa 41:25; Jer 50:9
v19 — Dan 4:30; Jer 51:41; Amos 4:11; Zeph 2:9; Jer 50:40
v20 — Jer 51:43; Isa 14:23

Chapter 14

The LORD will have mercy on Jacob and set Israel in their own land. Israel will take up a taunt against the king of Babylon, who said in his heart he would ascend above the stars of God. He will be brought down to hell. The LORD also declares judgment against Assyria and Philistia.

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| 1 <i>For the LORD will have mercy on Jacob, and will yet choose Israel, and set them in their own land: and the strangers shall be joined with them, and they shall cleave to the house of Jacob.</i> | For the LORD will have mercy on Jacob and will again choose Israel and settle them in their own land. Foreigners will join them and attach themselves to the house of Jacob. |
| 2 <i>And the people shall take them, and bring them to their place: and the house of Israel shall possess them in the land of the LORD for servants and handmaids: and they shall take them captives, whose captives they were; and they shall rule over their oppressors.</i> | The peoples will take them and bring them to their place. The house of Israel will possess them as servants in the LORD's land. They shall take captive those who were their captors and rule over those who oppressed them. |
| 3 <i>And it shall come to pass in the day that the LORD shall give thee rest from thy sorrow, and from thy fear, and from the hard bondage wherein thou wast made to serve,</i> | In the day the LORD gives You rest from Your pain, Your turmoil, and the hard service You were forced to do, |
| 4 <i>That thou shalt take up this proverb against the king of Babylon, and say, How hath the oppressor ceased! the golden city ceased!</i> | you will take up this taunt against the king of Babylon: "How the oppressor has ceased, the fury ended! |
| 5 <i>The LORD hath broken the staff of the wicked, and the sceptre of the rulers.</i> | The LORD has broken the staff of the wicked, the scepter of rulers, |
| 6 <i>He who smote the people in wrath with a continual stroke, he that ruled the nations in anger, is persecuted, and none hindereth.</i> | that struck the peoples in anger with unceasing blows, that ruled the nations in fury with relentless persecution. |
| 7 <i>The whole earth is at rest, and is quiet: they break forth into singing.</i> | The whole earth is at rest and quiet; they break forth into singing. |

- 8 *Yea, the fir trees rejoice at thee, and the cedars of Lebanon, saying, Since thou art laid down, no feller is come up against us.* Even the cypress trees rejoice over You, and the cedars of Lebanon, saying, 'Since You were laid low, no woodcutter comes up against us.'
- 9 *Hell from beneath is moved for thee to meet thee at thy coming: it stirreth up the dead for thee, even all the chief ones of the earth; it hath raised up from their thrones all the kings of the nations.* Hell beneath is stirred up to meet You when You come; it rouses the spirits of the dead for You — all the leaders of the earth. It raises from their thrones all the kings of the nations.
- 10 *All they shall speak and say unto thee, Art thou also become weak as we? art thou become like unto us?* All of them will speak and say to You, 'Have You also become weak as we? Have You become like us?'
- 11 *Thy pomp is brought down to the grave, and the noise of thy viols: the worm is spread under thee, and the worms cover thee.* Your pride has been brought down to hell, along with the music of Your harps. Maggots are Your bed below, and worms cover You."
- 12 *How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son of the morning! how art thou cut down to the ground, which didst weaken the nations!* "How You have fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son of the morning! How You have been cut down to the ground — you who weakened the nations!
- 13 *For thou hast said in thine heart, I will ascend into heaven, I will exalt my throne above the stars of God: I will sit also upon the mount of the congregation, in the sides of the north:* You said in Your heart, 'I will ascend to heaven; I will raise my throne above the stars of God. I will sit on the mount of assembly, on the heights of the north.
- 14 *I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will be like the most High.* I will ascend above the tops of the clouds; I will be like the Most High.'
- 15 *Yet thou shalt be brought down to hell, to the sides of the pit.* But You are brought down to hell, to the far reaches of the pit."

- 16 *They that see thee shall narrowly look upon thee, and consider thee, saying, Is this the man that made the earth to tremble, that did shake kingdoms;* Those who see you shall stare at you and ponder over you: "Is this the man who made the earth tremble, who shook kingdoms,
- 17 *That made the world as a wilderness, and destroyed the cities thereof; that opened not the house of his prisoners?* who made the world like a wilderness and tore down its cities, who did not let his prisoners go home?"
- 18 *All the kings of the nations, even all of them, lie in glory, every one in his own house.* All the kings of the nations lie in honor, each in his own tomb.
- 19 *But thou art cast out of thy grave like an abominable branch, and as the raiment of those that are slain, thrust through with a sword, that go down to the stones of the pit; as a carcase trodden under feet.* But you are cast out of your tomb like a rejected branch, clothed with the slain — with those who are pierced by the sword — who go down to the stones of the pit, like a trampled corpse.
- 20 *Thou shalt not be joined with them in burial, because thou hast destroyed thy land, and slain thy people: the seed of evildoers shall never be renowned.* You will not be joined with them in burial, because you destroyed your land and killed your people. The seed of evildoers shall never be mentioned again.
- 21 *Prepare slaughter for his children for the iniquity of their fathers; that they do not rise, nor possess the land, nor fill the face of the world with cities.* Prepare a place to slaughter his sons for the iniquity of their fathers! They shall not rise to possess the earth or fill the face of the world with cities.
- 22 *For I will rise up against them, saith the LORD of hosts, and cut off from Babylon the name, and remnant, and son, and nephew, saith the LORD.* "I will rise up against them," says the LORD of hosts. "I will cut off from Babylon name and remnant, offspring and descendants," says the LORD.
- 23 *I will also make it a possession for the bittern, and pools of water: and I will sweep it with the besom of destruction, saith the LORD of hosts.* "I will make it a possession of the bittern and pools of water. I will sweep it with the besom of destruction," says the LORD of hosts.

- 24 *The LORD of hosts hath sworn, saying, Surely as I have thought, so shall it come to pass; and as I have purposed, so shall it stand:* The LORD of hosts has sworn: "As I have planned, so shall it be. As I have purposed, so shall it stand:
- 25 *That I will break the Assyrian in my land, and upon my mountains tread him under foot: then shall his yoke depart from off them, and his burden depart from off their shoulders.* I will break the Assyrian in My land, and on My mountains trample Him underfoot. His yoke shall depart from them, and His burden from their shoulder."
- 26 *This is the purpose that is purposed upon the whole earth: and this is the hand that is stretched out upon all the nations.* This is the purpose purposed for the whole earth; this is the hand stretched out over all the nations.
- 27 *For the LORD of hosts hath purposed, and who shall disannul it? and his hand is stretched out, and who shall turn it back?* For the LORD of hosts has purposed, and who can annul it? His hand is stretched out, and who can turn it back?
- 28 *In the year that king Ahaz died was this burden.* In the year that King Ahaz died, this burden came:
- 29 *Rejoice not thou, whole Palestina, because the rod of him that smote thee is broken: for out of the serpent's root shall come forth a cockatrice, and his fruit shall be a fiery flying serpent.* Do not rejoice, O Philistia, all of you, that the rod that struck you is broken. For from the root of the serpent shall come a viper, and its fruit shall be a flying fiery serpent.
- 30 *And the firstborn of the poor shall feed, and the needy shall lie down in safety: and I will kill thy root with famine, and he shall slay thy remnant.* The firstborn of the poor shall graze, and the needy shall lie down in safety. But I will kill your root with famine, and it shall slay your remnant.
- 31 *Howl, O gate; cry, O city; thou, whole Palestina, art dissolved: for there shall come from the north a smoke, and none shall be alone in his appointed times.* Wail, O gate! Cry out, O city! You are melting away, O Philistia, all of you! For smoke comes from the north, and there is no straggler in its ranks.

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| <p>32 <i>What shall one then answer the messengers of the nation? That the LORD hath founded Zion, and the poor of his people shall trust in it.</i></p> | <p>What will one answer the messengers of the nations? That the LORD has founded Zion, and in her the afflicted of His people find refuge.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

besom (*BEE-zum*) — A broom made of twigs — Isaiah 14:23 says God will sweep Babylon away with the besom of destruction.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 102:13; Zech 1:17; Zech 8:22-23; Eph 2:12-19; Isa 54:7-8
- v2 — Isa 61:5; Isa 60:14; Jer 30:16
- v3 — Jer 30:10; Ezra 9:8-9; Isa 32:18
- v12 — Ezek 28:13-17; Rev 12:7-10; Luke 10:18; Rev 8:10; Rev 22:16
- v13 — Dan 8:10-12; Ezek 28:2; Ezek 28:12-16
- v14 — Isa 47:8; Gen 3:5; 2 Thess 2:4
- v16 — Jer 50:23; Ps 58:10-11; Jer 51:20-23
- v23 — Zeph 2:14; Isa 13:21-22; 1 Kgs 14:10; Rev 14:8; Isa 34:11-15
- v24 — Prov 19:21; Isa 46:10-11; Job 23:13; Jer 29:11; Acts 4:28
- v27 — Isa 43:13; Job 23:13; 2 Chr 20:6; Prov 21:30; Job 9:12
- v29 — Isa 11:8; Isa 30:6; 2 Chr 26:6
- v32 — Ps 87:5; Ps 102:16; Ps 87:1; Jas 2:5; Zeph 3:12

Chapter 15

Isaiah pronounces the burden against Moab. In one night Ar of Moab is laid waste and Kir of Moab is destroyed. The people flee, weeping as they go, and the waters of Nimrim are desolate.

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| <p>1 <i>The burden of Moab. Because in the night Ar of Moab is laid waste, and brought to silence; because in the night Kir of Moab is laid waste, and brought to silence;</i></p> | <p>The burden of Moab. In a night Ar of Moab is laid waste and reduced to silence. In a night Kir of Moab is laid waste and reduced to silence.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>He is gone up to Bajith, and to Dibon, the high places, to weep: Moab shall howl over Nebo, and over Medeba: on all their heads shall be baldness, and every beard cut off.</i></p> | <p>They go up to the temple, to Dibon and the high places to weep. Moab wails over Nebo and over Medeba. Every head is shaved and every beard cut off.</p> |

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| 3 | <i>In their streets they shall gird themselves with sackcloth: on the tops of their houses, and in their streets, every one shall howl, weeping abundantly.</i> | In their streets they put on sackcloth. On their rooftops and in their squares, everyone wails, melting in tears. |
| 4 | <i>And Heshbon shall cry, and Elealeh: their voice shall be heard even unto Jahaz: therefore the armed soldiers of Moab shall cry out; his life shall be grievous unto him.</i> | Heshbon and Elealeh cry out; their voices are heard as far as Jahaz. Therefore the warriors of Moab cry out; his soul trembles within him. |
| 5 | <i>My heart shall cry out for Moab; his fugitives shall flee unto Zoar, an heifer of three years old: for by the mounting up of Luhith with weeping shall they go it up; for in the way of Horonaim they shall raise up a cry of destruction.</i> | My heart cries out for Moab. His fugitives flee to Zoar, to Eglath-shelishiyah. For at the ascent of Luhith they go up weeping; on the road to Horonaim they raise a cry of destruction. |
| 6 | <i>For the waters of Nimrim shall be desolate: for the hay is withered away, the grass faileth, there is no green thing.</i> | For the waters of Nimrim are desolate; the grass is withered, the vegetation fails, there is nothing green. |
| 7 | <i>Therefore the abundance they have gotten, and that which they have laid up, shall they carry away to the brook of the willows.</i> | Therefore the abundance they have gained and what they have stored up they carry away over the Brook of the Willows. |
| 8 | <i>For the cry is gone round about the borders of Moab; the howling thereof unto Eglaim, and the howling thereof unto Beerelim.</i> | The cry has gone around the borders of Moab. Its wailing reaches to Eglaim; its wailing reaches to Beer-elim. |
| 9 | <i>For the waters of Dimon shall be full of blood: for I will bring more upon Dimon, lions upon him that escapeth of Moab, and upon the remnant of the land.</i> | For the waters of Dibon are full of blood; yet I will bring even more on Dibon — a lion for those of Moab who escape, and for the remnant of the land. |

Words in this chapter:

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Amos 2:1-3; Jer 48:1-47

v5 — Jer 48:5

v9 — 2 Kgs 17:25

Chapter 16

Isaiah continues the burden against Moab. The Moabites are counseled to send tribute to Zion, and a throne will be established in mercy in the tent of David. Moab howls for her destroyed fields and vineyards, and within three years her glory will be brought low.

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| <p>1 <i>Send ye the lamb to the ruler of the land from Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the daughter of Zion.</i></p> | <p>Send the tribute lamb to the ruler of the land — from Sela, through the wilderness, to the mount of the daughter of Zion.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For it shall be, that, as a wandering bird cast out of the nest, so the daughters of Moab shall be at the fords of Arnon.</i></p> | <p>Like fluttering birds pushed from the nest, so are the daughters of Moab at the fords of the Arnon.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Take counsel, execute judgment; make thy shadow as the night in the midst of the noonday; hide the outcasts; bewray not him that wandereth.</i></p> | <p>"Give counsel; grant justice. Make your shadow like night at noon. Hide the outcasts; do not betray the fugitive.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Let mine outcasts dwell with thee, Moab; be thou a covert to them from the face of the spoiler: for the extortioner is at an end, the spoiler ceaseth, the oppressors are consumed out of the land.</i></p> | <p>Let the outcasts of Moab stay with you; be a shelter to them from the destroyer. When the oppressor is no more and destruction has ceased and the enemy has gone from the land,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And in mercy shall the throne be established: and he shall sit upon it in truth in the tabernacle of David, judging, and seeking judgment, and hasting righteousness.</i></p> | <p>then a throne shall be established in mercy, and on it shall sit in faithfulness, in the tent of David, one who judges and seeks justice and is swift to do righteousness."</p> |

- 6 *We have heard of the pride of Moab; he is very proud: even of his haughtiness, and his pride, and his wrath: but his lies shall not be so.* We have heard of the pride of Moab — how proud he is — of his arrogance, his pride, and his insolence. His boasts are empty.
- 7 *Therefore shall Moab howl for Moab, every one shall howl: for the foundations of Kirhareth shall ye mourn; surely they are stricken.* Therefore Moab wails for Moab — everyone wails. For the raisin cakes of Kir-hareth you shall mourn — utterly stricken.
- 8 *For the fields of Heshbon languish, and the vine of Sibmah: the lords of the heathen have broken down the principal plants thereof, they are come even unto Jazer, they wandered through the wilderness: her branches are stretched out, they are gone over the sea.* For the fields of Heshbon wither, the vine of Sibmah. The lords of the nations have struck down its choice branches, which reached to Jazer and wandered into the wilderness. Its shoots spread out and crossed over the sea.
- 9 *Therefore I will bewail with the weeping of Jazer the vine of Sibmah: I will water thee with my tears, O Heshbon, and Elealeh: for the shouting for thy summer fruits and for thy harvest is fallen.* Therefore I weep with the weeping of Jazer for the vine of Sibmah. I drench you with my tears, O Heshbon and Elealeh, for over your summer fruit and your harvest the shout has fallen away.
- 10 *And gladness is taken away, and joy out of the plentiful field; and in the vineyards there shall be no singing, neither shall there be shouting: the treaders shall tread out no wine in their presses; I have made their vintage shouting to cease.* Gladness and joy are taken away from the fruitful field. In the vineyards there is no singing and no shouting. No one treads out wine in the presses; I have put an end to the harvest shout.
- 11 *Wherefore my bowels shall sound like an harp for Moab, and mine inward parts for Kirhareth.* Therefore my heart moans for Moab like a harp, and my inmost being for Kir-hareth.

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| <p>12 <i>And it shall come to pass, when it is seen that Moab is weary on the high place, that he shall come to his sanctuary to pray; but he shall not prevail.</i></p> | <p>When Moab presents himself, when he wearies himself on the high place, when he comes to his sanctuary to pray, he shall not prevail.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>This is the word that the LORD hath spoken concerning Moab since that time.</i></p> | <p>This is the word the LORD spoke concerning Moab in the past.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>But now the LORD hath spoken, saying, Within three years, as the years of an hireling, and the glory of Moab shall be condemned, with all that great multitude; and the remnant shall be very small and feeble.</i></p> | <p>But now the LORD has spoken:
"Within three years, like the years of a hired worker, the glory of Moab will be brought into contempt — despite all His great crowd. What remains will be very small and weak."</p> |

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 10:32; 2 Kgs 3:4; 2 Kgs 14:7

v5 — Dan 7:14; Mic 4:7; Isa 9:6-7; Dan 7:27

v6 — Amos 2:1

v11 — Isa 15:5

v12 — Isa 15:2

Chapter 17

Isaiah pronounces the burden against Damascus. Damascus will cease to be a city and become a ruinous heap. Israel's glory will also grow thin. In that day a man will look to his Maker rather than to altars made by his own hands.

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| <p>1 <i>The burden of Damascus. Behold, Damascus is taken away from being a city, and it shall be a ruinous heap.</i></p> | <p>The burden of Damascus. Damascus will cease to be a city; it will become a heap of ruins.</p> |
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- 2 *The cities of Aroer are forsaken: they shall be for flocks, which shall lie down, and none shall make them afraid.* The cities of Aroer are abandoned — left for flocks that shall lie down with no one to disturb them.
- 3 *The fortress also shall cease from Ephraim, and the kingdom from Damascus, and the remnant of Syria: they shall be as the glory of the children of Israel, saith the LORD of hosts.* The fortress shall disappear from Ephraim, and the kingdom from Damascus. The remnant of Syria shall be like the fading glory of the children of Israel, declares the LORD of hosts.
- 4 *And in that day it shall come to pass, that the glory of Jacob shall be made thin, and the fatness of his flesh shall wax lean.* In that day the glory of Jacob shall fade, and the fat of his body shall grow lean.
- 5 *And it shall be as when the harvestman gathereth the corn, and reapeth the ears with his arm; and it shall be as he that gathereth ears in the valley of Rephaim.* It shall be as when a reaper gathers standing grain and his arm harvests the ears — as when one gleans ears of grain in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 6 *Yet gleaning grapes shall be left in it, as the shaking of an olive tree, two or three berries in the top of the uppermost bough, four or five in the outmost fruitful branches thereof, saith the LORD God of Israel.* Yet gleanings shall be left in it, as when an olive tree is beaten — two or three berries in the top of the highest branch, four or five on the branches of a fruitful tree, declares the LORD God of Israel.
- 7 *At that day shall a man look to his Maker, and his eyes shall have respect to the Holy One of Israel.* In that day men shall look to their Maker, and their eyes shall regard the Holy One of Israel.
- 8 *And he shall not look to the altars, the work of his hands, neither shall respect that which his fingers have made, either the groves, or the images.* They shall not look to the altars — the work of their hands — nor shall they regard what their fingers have made, either the groves or the images.

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| <p>9 <i>In that day shall his strong cities be as a forsaken bough, and an uppermost branch, which they left because of the children of Israel: and there shall be desolation.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Because thou hast forgotten the God of thy salvation, and hast not been mindful of the rock of thy strength, therefore shalt thou plant pleasant plants, and shalt set it with strange slips:</i></p> <p>11 <i>In the day shalt thou make thy plant to grow, and in the morning shalt thou make thy seed to flourish: but the harvest shall be a heap in the day of grief and of desperate sorrow.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Woe to the multitude of many people, which make a noise like the noise of the seas; and to the rushing of nations, that make a rushing like the rushing of mighty waters!</i></p> <p>13 <i>The nations shall rush like the rushing of many waters: but God shall rebuke them, and they shall flee far off, and shall be chased as the chaff of the mountains before the wind, and like a rolling thing before the whirlwind.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And behold at eveningtide trouble; and before the morning he is not. This is the portion of them that spoil us, and the lot of them that rob us.</i></p> | <p>In that day their strong cities shall be like abandoned places in the forest, like the deserted summits that the Israelites abandoned — there shall be desolation.</p> <p>For You have forgotten the God of Your salvation and have not remembered the Rock of Your strength. Therefore, though You plant pleasant gardens and set out slips of a foreign vine,</p> <p>though You make them grow on the day You plant them and make them blossom on the morning You sow, the harvest shall flee away on a day of grief and desperate sorrow.</p> <p>Woe to the roar of many peoples — they roar like the roaring of the seas! Woe to the surging of nations — they surge like the surging of mighty waters!</p> <p>The nations rush like the rushing of many waters, but He will rebuke them and they shall flee far away — chased like chaff on the mountains before the wind and like dust before the storm.</p> <p>At evening time — terror! Before morning — they are gone! This is the portion of those who plunder us, and the fate of those who rob us.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Amos 1:3-5; Isa 25:2; Zech 9:1
v2 — Jer 7:33; Ezek 25:5
v3 — Isa 7:16; Isa 8:4; Hos 9:11
v4 — Isa 10:16
v5 — Matt 13:30; Joel 3:13; Jer 51:33
v6 — Isa 24:13
v7 — Mic 7:7; Hos 6:1
v8 — Isa 30:22
v10 — Isa 26:4; Jer 2:32; Deut 32:18; Ps 106:21; Hos 13:6-7
v11 — Job 4:8; Hos 8:7
v12 — Jer 6:23; Ps 18:4; Luke 21:25
v13 — Ps 9:5

Chapter 18

Isaiah prophesies woe to the land beyond the rivers of Ethiopia that sends ambassadors by sea. The LORD will watch quietly as the Assyrian threat ripens, then cut it down. Afterward gifts will be brought to the LORD of hosts from a people tall and smooth-skinned.

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| <p>1 <i>Woe to the land shadowing with wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia:</i></p> | <p>Woe to the land of whirring wings, which is beyond the rivers of Cush,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>That sendeth ambassadors by the sea, even in vessels of bulrushes upon the waters, saying, Go, ye swift messengers, to a nation scattered and peeled, to a people terrible from their beginning hitherto; a nation meted out and trodden down, whose land the rivers have spoiled!</i></p> | <p>which sends ambassadors by sea, in vessels of papyrus on the waters! Go, swift messengers, to a nation tall and smooth-skinned — to a people feared near and far — a nation mighty and trampling, whose land the rivers divide.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>All ye inhabitants of the world, and dwellers on the earth, see ye, when he lifteth up an ensign on the mountains; and when he bloweth a trumpet, hear ye.</i></p> | <p>All You inhabitants of the world and dwellers on the earth — when an ensign is raised on the mountains, look! When a trumpet is blown, hear!</p> |

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| <p>4 <i>For so the LORD said unto me, I will take my rest, and I will consider in my dwelling place like a clear heat upon herbs, and like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest.</i></p> <p>5 <i>For afore the harvest, when the bud is perfect, and the sour grape is ripening in the flower, he shall both cut off the sprigs with pruning hooks, and take away and cut down the branches.</i></p> <p>6 <i>They shall be left together unto the fowls of the mountains, and to the beasts of the earth: and the fowls shall summer upon them, and all the beasts of the earth shall winter upon them.</i></p> <p>7 <i>In that time shall the present be brought unto the LORD of hosts of a people scattered and peeled, and from a people terrible from their beginning hitherto; a nation meted out and trodden under foot, whose land the rivers have spoiled, to the place of the name of the LORD of hosts, the mount Zion.</i></p> | <p>For the LORD said to me, "I will quietly look from My dwelling like shimmering heat in sunshine, like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest."</p> <p>For before the harvest, when the blossom is over and the flower becomes a ripening grape, He will cut off the shoots with pruning hooks, and the spreading branches He will cut away.</p> <p>They shall all be left to the birds of the mountains and the beasts of the earth. The birds of prey shall summer on them, and all the beasts of the earth shall winter on them.</p> <p>At that time a gift shall be brought to the LORD of hosts from a people tall and smooth-skinned — from a people feared near and far, a nation mighty and conquering, whose land the rivers divide — to the place of the name of the LORD of hosts, to Mount Zion.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Zeph 3:10; 2 Kgs 19:9; Ezek 30:4-5; Zeph 2:12

v3 — Isa 5:26

v4 — Hos 5:15; Isa 26:21

v7 — Zeph 3:10; Zech 14:16-17; Acts 8:27-28

Chapter 19

Isaiah pronounces the burden against Egypt. The LORD rides on a swift cloud into Egypt, and the idols tremble. Egypt will be given over to a fierce king, the Nile will dry up, and the wise counselors of Pharaoh will become fools. In that day Egypt and Assyria will worship the LORD together with Israel, and Egypt will be called the LORD's people.

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| 1 <i>The burden of Egypt. Behold, the LORD rideth upon a swift cloud, and shall come into Egypt: and the idols of Egypt shall be moved at his presence, and the heart of Egypt shall melt in the midst of it.</i> | The burden of Egypt. The LORD is riding on a swift cloud and comes to Egypt. The idols of Egypt tremble before Him, and the heart of Egypt melts within it. |
| 2 <i>And I will set the Egyptians against the Egyptians: and they shall fight every one against his brother, and every one against his neighbour; city against city, and kingdom against kingdom.</i> | I will stir up Egyptians against Egyptians, and they shall fight — each against His brother and each against His neighbor — city against city, kingdom against kingdom. |
| 3 <i>And the spirit of Egypt shall fail in the midst thereof; and I will destroy the counsel thereof: and they shall seek to the idols, and to the charmers, and to them that have familiar spirits, and to the wizards.</i> | The spirit of Egypt shall fail within it, and I will confuse their counsel. They shall seek guidance from the idols, from the charmers, and from those who have familiar spirits, and from the wizards. |
| 4 <i>And the Egyptians will I give over into the hand of a cruel lord; and a fierce king shall rule over them, saith the Lord, the LORD of hosts.</i> | I will give over the Egyptians into the hand of a harsh master, and a fierce king shall rule over them, declares the Lord, the LORD of hosts. |
| 5 <i>And the waters shall fail from the sea, and the river shall be wasted and dried up.</i> | The waters of the Nile shall be dried up; the river shall be parched and dry. |
| 6 <i>And they shall turn the rivers far away; and the brooks of defence shall be emptied and dried up: the reeds and flags shall wither.</i> | Its canals shall stink; the streams of Egypt shall dry up. The reeds and rushes shall wither. |

- 7 *The paper reeds by the brooks, by the mouth of the brooks, and every thing sown by the brooks, shall wither, be driven away, and be no more.* The plants along the Nile, at the mouth of the Nile, and everything sown by the Nile shall dry up and blow away and be no more.
- 8 *The fishers also shall mourn, and all they that cast angle into the brooks shall lament, and they that spread nets upon the waters shall languish.* The fishermen shall mourn; all who cast hooks into the Nile shall grieve; those who spread nets on the water shall waste away.
- 9 *Moreover they that work in fine flax, and they that weave networks, shall be confounded.* Those who work with combed flax and those who weave white cloth shall be put to shame.
- 10 *And they shall be broken in the purposes thereof, all that make sluices and ponds for fish.* The weavers of Egypt shall be crushed; all who make wages shall be grieved.
- 11 *Surely the princes of Zoan are fools, the counsel of the wise counsellors of Pharaoh is become brutish: how say ye unto Pharaoh, I am the son of the wise, the son of ancient kings?* The princes of Zoan are complete fools; the wise counselors of Pharaoh give stupid advice. How can you say to Pharaoh, "I am a son of the wise, a son of ancient kings"?
- 12 *Where are they? where are thy wise men? and let them tell thee now, and let them know what the LORD of hosts hath purposed upon Egypt.* Where then are Your wise men? Let them tell You and make known what the LORD of hosts has purposed against Egypt.
- 13 *The princes of Zoan are become fools, the princes of Noph are deceived; they have also seduced Egypt, even they that are the stay of the tribes thereof.* The princes of Zoan have become fools; the princes of Memphis are deluded. Those who are the cornerstone of her tribes have led Egypt astray.
- 14 *The LORD hath mingled a perverse spirit in the midst thereof: and they have caused Egypt to err in every work thereof, as a drunken man staggereth in his vomit.* The LORD has mixed into her a spirit of confusion, and they have made Egypt stagger in all its deeds, as a drunkard staggers in His vomit.

- 15 *Neither shall there be any work for Egypt, which the head or tail, branch or rush, may do.* There shall be nothing for Egypt to do — neither head nor tail, palm branch nor reed.
- 16 *In that day shall Egypt be like unto women: and it shall be afraid and fear because of the shaking of the hand of the LORD of hosts, which he shaketh over it.* In that day the Egyptians shall be like women — trembling with fear because of the hand that the LORD of hosts shakes over them.
- 17 *And the land of Judah shall be a terror unto Egypt, every one that maketh mention thereof shall be afraid in himself, because of the counsel of the LORD of hosts, which he hath determined against it.* The land of Judah shall become a terror to Egypt. Whenever anyone mentions it, Egypt shall dread it because of the purpose the LORD of hosts has purposed against it.
- 18 *In that day shall five cities in the land of Egypt speak the language of Canaan, and swear to the LORD of hosts; one shall be called, The city of destruction.* In that day there shall be five cities in Egypt that speak the language of Canaan and swear allegiance to the LORD of hosts. One shall be called the City of Destruction.
- 19 *In that day shall there be an altar to the LORD in the midst of the land of Egypt, and a pillar at the border thereof to the LORD.* In that day there shall be an altar to the LORD in the midst of Egypt, and a pillar to the LORD at its border.
- 20 *And it shall be for a sign and for a witness unto the LORD of hosts in the land of Egypt: for they shall cry unto the LORD because of the oppressors, and he shall send them a saviour, and a great one, and he shall deliver them.* It shall be a sign and a witness to the LORD of hosts in the land of Egypt. When they cry to the LORD because of oppressors, He will send them a savior and defender, and He will deliver them.
- 21 *And the LORD shall be known to Egypt, and the Egyptians shall know the LORD in that day, and shall do sacrifice and oblation; yea, they shall vow a vow unto the LORD, and perform it.* The LORD will make Himself known to Egypt, and the Egyptians will know the LORD in that day. They will worship with sacrifice and offering, and they will make vows to the LORD and keep them.

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| <p>22 <i>And the LORD shall smite Egypt: he shall smite and heal it: and they shall return even to the LORD, and he shall be intreated of them, and shall heal them.</i></p> <p>23 <i>In that day shall there be a highway out of Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria, and the Egyptians shall serve with the Assyrians.</i></p> <p>24 <i>In that day shall Israel be the third with Egypt and with Assyria, even a blessing in the midst of the land:</i></p> <p>25 <i>Whom the LORD of hosts shall bless, saying, Blessed be Egypt my people, and Assyria the work of my hands, and Israel mine inheritance.</i></p> | <p>The LORD will strike Egypt, striking but healing. They shall turn to the LORD, and He will respond to their pleas and heal them.</p> <p>In that day there shall be a highway from Egypt to Assyria. The Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria, and the Egyptians shall worship with the Assyrians.</p> <p>In that day Israel shall be the third with Egypt and with Assyria — a blessing in the midst of the earth,</p> <p>whom the LORD of hosts has blessed, saying, "Blessed be Egypt My people, Assyria the work of My hands, and Israel My inheritance."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 12:12; Rev 1:7
- v2 — Judg 7:22; 1 Sam 14:20; Matt 10:36
- v3 — Isa 8:19; Dan 2:2
- v4 — Isa 20:4; Jer 46:26; Ezek 29:19
- v9 — Ezek 27:7
- v11 — Num 13:22
- v13 — Jer 2:16; Ezek 30:13
- v16 — Nah 3:13; Jer 51:30
- v18 — Zeph 3:9
- v22 — Heb 12:11; Deut 32:39
- v23 — Isa 11:16
- v25 — Isa 29:23; Rom 9:24-25; Hos 2:23; Ps 138:8; Ps 115:15

Chapter 20

The LORD commands Isaiah to walk naked and barefoot for three years as a sign that the king of Assyria will lead away Egyptian and Ethiopian captives, young and old, naked and barefoot. Those who trusted in Ethiopia and Egypt for deliverance will be ashamed.

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| <p>¹ <i>In the year that Tartan came unto Ashdod, (when Sargon the king of Assyria sent him,) and fought against Ashdod, and took it;</i></p> | <p>In the year that the Tartan came to Ashdod — when Sargon the king of Assyria sent him — he fought against Ashdod and captured it.</p> |
| <p>² <i>At the same time spake the LORD by Isaiah the son of Amoz, saying, Go and loose the sackcloth from off thy loins, and put off thy shoe from thy foot. And he did so, walking naked and barefoot.</i></p> | <p>At that time the LORD spoke through Isaiah the son of Amoz, saying, "Go, remove the sackcloth from Your waist and take off Your sandals from Your feet." He did so, walking naked and barefoot.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And the LORD said, Like as my servant Isaiah hath walked naked and barefoot three years for a sign and wonder upon Egypt and upon Ethiopia;</i></p> | <p>The LORD said, "Just as My servant Isaiah has walked naked and barefoot for three years as a sign and a wonder against Egypt and Cush,</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>So shall the king of Assyria lead away the Egyptians prisoners, and the Ethiopians captives, young and old, naked and barefoot, even with their buttocks uncovered, to the shame of Egypt.</i></p> | <p>so shall the king of Assyria lead away the captives of Egypt and the exiles of Cush, young and old, naked and barefoot, with their buttocks uncovered — the shame of Egypt.</p> |
| <p>⁵ <i>And they shall be afraid and ashamed of Ethiopia their expectation, and of Egypt their glory.</i></p> | <p>They shall be terrified and put to shame because of Cush their hope and of Egypt their boast.</p> |
| <p>⁶ <i>And the inhabitant of this isle shall say in that day, Behold, such is our expectation, whither we flee for help to be delivered from the king of Assyria: and how shall we escape?</i></p> | <p>The inhabitants of this coastland shall say in that day, 'Such is our hope — those to whom we fled for help and deliverance from the king of Assyria! How shall we escape?' "</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Kgs 18:17

v2 — 1 Sam 19:24; Matt 3:4; Mic 1:8

v3 — Isa 8:18

v4 — Isa 19:4

Chapter 21

Isaiah pronounces the burden of the desert of the sea -- Babylon is fallen, is fallen, and all the graven images of her gods are broken to the ground. He also pronounces burdens against Dumah and Arabia, declaring that within a year the glory of Kedar will fail.

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| <p>1 <i>The burden of the desert of the sea. As whirlwinds in the south pass through; so it cometh from the desert, from a terrible land.</i></p> | <p>The burden of the Desert of the Sea. Like whirlwinds sweeping through the south, it comes from the desert, from a fearful land.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>A grievous vision is declared unto me; the treacherous dealer dealeth treacherously, and the spoiler spoileth. Go up, O Elam: besiege, O Media; all the sighing thereof have I made to cease.</i></p> | <p>A harsh vision has been shown to me. The traitor betrays, the destroyer destroys. "Go up, O Elam! Besiege, O Media!" I have put an end to all the groaning.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Therefore are my loins filled with pain: pangs have taken hold upon me, as the pangs of a woman that travaileth: I was bowed down at the hearing of it; I was dismayed at the seeing of it.</i></p> | <p>Therefore my whole body is filled with anguish; pains have seized me like the pains of a woman in labor. I am too troubled to hear; I am too dismayed to see.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>My heart panted, fearfulness affrighted me: the night of my pleasure hath he turned into fear unto me.</i></p> | <p>My heart reels; horror has overwhelmed me. The twilight I longed for has become dread for me.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Prepare the table, watch in the watchtower, eat, drink: arise, ye princes, and anoint the shield.</i></p> | <p>Prepare the table; set the watch; eat and drink. Arise, O princes! Oil the shield!</p> |

- 6 *For thus hath the Lord said unto me, Go, set a watchman, let him declare what he seeth.* For thus the Lord said to me: "Go, post a watchman; let him announce what he sees."
- 7 *And he saw a chariot with a couple of horsemen, a chariot of asses, and a chariot of camels; and he hearkened diligently with much heed:* When he sees riders — horsemen in pairs, riders on donkeys, riders on camels — let him listen carefully, very carefully.
- 8 *And he cried, A lion: My lord, I stand continually upon the watchtower in the daytime, and I am set in my ward whole nights:* Then the watchman called out: "O Lord, I stand on the watchtower all day long; I have been stationed at my post every night.
- 9 *And, behold, here cometh a chariot of men, with a couple of horsemen. And he answered and said, Babylon is fallen, is fallen; and all the graven images of her gods he hath broken unto the ground.* And a troop of men is coming, horsemen in pairs!" He answered, "Fallen, fallen is Babylon! All the carved images of her gods are shattered to the ground."
- 10 *O my threshing, and the corn of my floor: that which I have heard of the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, have I declared unto you.* O my threshed and winnowed one, what I have heard from the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, I now declare to You.
- 11 *The burden of Dumah. He calleth to me out of Seir, Watchman, what of the night? Watchman, what of the night?* The burden of Dumah. Someone is calling to me from Seir: "Watchman, how much of the night is left? Watchman, how much of the night is left?"
- 12 *The watchman said, The morning cometh, and also the night: if ye will enquire, enquire ye: return, come.* The watchman says, "Morning comes, and also night. If You will inquire, come back and inquire."
- 13 *The burden upon Arabia. In the forest in Arabia shall ye lodge, O ye travelling companies of Dedanim.* The burden against Arabia. In the thickets of Arabia You shall lodge, O caravans of Dedanites.

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| <p>14 <i>The inhabitants of the land of Tema brought water to him that was thirsty, they prevented with their bread him that fled.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For they fled from the swords, from the drawn sword, and from the bent bow, and from the grievousness of war.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For thus hath the Lord said unto me, Within a year, according to the years of an hireling, and all the glory of Kedar shall fail:</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the residue of the number of archers, the mighty men of the children of Kedar, shall be diminished: for the LORD God of Israel hath spoken it.</i></p> | <p>Bring water for the thirsty; the inhabitants of the land of Tema meet the fugitive with bread.</p> <p>For they have fled from the swords, from the drawn sword, from the bent bow, and from the fierce battle.</p> <p>For thus the Lord has said to me: "Within a year, like the years of a hired worker, all the glory of Kedar shall come to an end.</p> <p>The surviving archers of Kedar's warriors shall be few, for the LORD God of Israel has spoken."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burden (*BUR-den*) — a prophetic oracle of judgment; a heavy word from the LORD against a nation

watchman (*WOTCH-man*) — one set to look for approaching danger; the prophet as God's sentinel over the nations

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 14:23; Jer 51:42; Isa 13:1

v2 — Jer 49:34; Isa 33:1

v3 — Isa 13:8

v6 — Ezek 33:2-7; Ezek 3:17; Hab 2:1-2

v9 — Rev 18:2; Jer 51:8; Rev 14:8

v10 — Jer 51:33; Mic 4:13

v11 — Gen 25:14; Obad 1:1-16; Amos 1:6

v12 — Acts 17:30-32

v13 — Jer 25:23-24

v16 — Isa 60:7; Ps 120:5; Isa 16:14; Song 1:5

Chapter 22

Isaiah pronounces the burden of the valley of vision -- Jerusalem. The people prepare their defenses but do not look to the God who made them. The LORD calls for weeping and mourning, but they feast instead, saying, 'Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die.' Shebna the steward is removed from office and replaced by Eliakim.

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| <p>1 <i>The burden of the valley of vision.
What aileth thee now, that thou art
wholly gone up to the housetops?</i></p> | <p>The burden of the Valley of Vision.
What is wrong with You now, that
You have all gone up to the rooftops?</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thou that art full of stirs, a
tumultuous city, a joyous city: thy
slain men are not slain with the
sword, nor dead in battle.</i></p> | <p>You who were full of commotion, a
riotous and joyful city — your slain
were not slain with the sword, nor did
they die in battle.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>All thy rulers are fled together, they
are bound by the archers: all that are
found in thee are bound together,
which have fled from far.</i></p> | <p>All Your rulers fled together; they
were captured without the bow. All of
You who were found were captured,
though You had fled far away.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Therefore said I, Look away from me;
I will weep bitterly, labour not to
comfort me, because of the spoiling of
the daughter of my people.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I said, "Look away from me;
let me weep bitterly. Do not labor to
comfort me over the destruction of the
daughter of my people."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For it is a day of trouble, and of
treading down, and of perplexity by
the Lord GOD of hosts in the valley of
vision, breaking down the walls, and
of crying to the mountains.</i></p> | <p>For the Lord GOD of hosts has a day
of panic, of trampling, and of
confusion in the Valley of Vision — a
day of breaking down walls and of
crying to the mountains.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And Elam bare the quiver with
chariots of men and horsemen, and
Kir uncovered the shield.</i></p> | <p>Elam bore the quiver, with chariots and
horsemen, and Kir uncovered the
shield.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And it shall come to pass, that thy
choicest valleys shall be full of
chariots, and the horsemen shall set
themselves in array at the gate.</i></p> | <p>Your choicest valleys were full of
chariots, and the horsemen were
positioned at the gate.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And he discovered the covering of
Judah, and thou didst look in that day
to the armour of the house of the
forest.</i></p> | <p>He stripped away the covering of
Judah. In that day You looked to the
weapons in the House of the Forest.</p> |

- 9 *Ye have seen also the breaches of the city of David, that they are many: and ye gathered together the waters of the lower pool.* You saw the breaches of the city of David, that they were many. You collected the waters of the lower pool.
- 10 *And ye have numbered the houses of Jerusalem, and the houses have ye broken down to fortify the wall.* You counted the houses of Jerusalem, and you tore down houses to strengthen the wall.
- 11 *Ye made also a ditch between the two walls for the water of the old pool: but ye have not looked unto the maker thereof, neither had respect unto him that fashioned it long ago.* You made a reservoir between the two walls for the water of the old pool — but you did not look to Him who made it, nor regard Him who planned it long ago.
- 12 *And in that day did the Lord GOD of hosts call to weeping, and to mourning, and to baldness, and to girding with sackcloth:* In that day the Lord GOD of hosts called for weeping and mourning, for shaving the head and putting on sackcloth.
- 13 *And behold joy and gladness, slaying oxen, and killing sheep, eating flesh, and drinking wine: let us eat and drink; for to morrow we shall die.* Instead, there was joy and gladness, killing oxen, slaughtering sheep, eating meat, and drinking wine. "Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die!"
- 14 *And it was revealed in mine ears by the LORD of hosts, Surely this iniquity shall not be purged from you till ye die, saith the Lord GOD of hosts.* The LORD of hosts revealed Himself in my hearing: "This iniquity will not be forgiven You until You die," says the Lord GOD of hosts.
- 15 *Thus saith the Lord GOD of hosts, Go, get thee unto this treasurer, even unto Shebna, which is over the house, and say,* Thus says the Lord GOD of hosts: "Go to this steward, to Shebna who is in charge of the household, and say to Him,
- 16 *What hast thou here? and whom hast thou here, that thou hast hewed thee out a sepulchre here, as he that heweth him out a sepulchre on high, and that graveth an habitation for himself in a rock?* "What have You here, and whom have You here, that You have cut out a tomb for Yourself here — cutting out a tomb on the height and carving a dwelling for Yourself in the rock?"

- 17 *Behold, the LORD will carry thee away with a mighty captivity, and will surely cover thee.* The LORD is about to hurl You away, mighty man! He will seize You firmly
- 18 *He will surely violently turn and toss thee like a ball into a large country: there shalt thou die, and there the chariots of thy glory shall be the shame of thy master's house.* and roll You up tightly like a ball and throw You into a wide land. There You shall die, and there Your glorious chariots shall be — a disgrace to Your master's house.'
- 19 *And I will drive thee from thy station, and from thy state shall he pull thee down.* I will thrust You from Your office, and You will be pulled down from Your post.
- 20 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will call my servant Eliakim the son of Hilkiah:* In that day I will call my servant Eliakim the son of Hilkiah,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Eliakim** (eh-LY-ah-kim) — "God will raise up" — A faithful steward who replaced the unfaithful Shebna; a type of Christ, who holds the key of the house of David.

- 21 *And I will clothe him with thy robe, and strengthen him with thy girdle, and I will commit thy government into his hand: and he shall be a father to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to the house of Judah.* I will clothe Him with Your robe and strengthen Him with Your belt. I will commit Your authority into His hand. He shall be a father to the inhabitants of Jerusalem and to the house of Judah.
- 22 *And the key of the house of David will I lay upon his shoulder; so he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open.* I will place on his shoulder the key of the house of David. What he opens, no one can shut; and what he shuts, no one can open.
- 23 *And I will fasten him as a nail in a sure place; and he shall be for a glorious throne to his father's house.* I will drive him like a peg into a firm place. He will become a throne of glory to his father's house.

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| <p>24 <i>And they shall hang upon him all the glory of his father's house, the offspring and the issue, all vessels of small quantity, from the vessels of cups, even to all the vessels of flagons.</i></p> <p>25 <i>In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, shall the nail that is fastened in the sure place be removed, and be cut down, and fall; and the burden that was upon it shall be cut off: for the LORD hath spoken it.</i></p> | <p>They shall hang on him the whole honor of his father's house — offspring and offspring's children, every small vessel, from bowls to all the jars.</p> <p>In that day, declares the LORD of hosts, the peg that was driven into the firm place will give way. It will be cut down and fall, and the load hanging on it will be cut off. The LORD has spoken.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 21:13
- v2 — Isa 32:13
- v4 — Jer 9:1
- v6 — 2 Kgs 16:9
- v11 — Mic 7:7; Jer 33:2-3
- v12 — Joel 2:17; Joel 1:13; Mic 1:16
- v13 — Isa 56:12; 1 Cor 15:32; Luke 17:26-29
- v14 — Ezek 24:13
- v15 — Isa 36:3; 2 Kgs 18:18
- v20 — Isa 36:3; 2 Kgs 18:18; Isa 37:2; Isa 36:22; 2 Kgs 18:37
- v22 — Matt 16:18-19; Rev 3:7; Job 12:14; Matt 18:18-19; Rev 1:18
- v23 — Job 36:7; Ezra 9:8

Chapter 23

Isaiah pronounces the burden against Tyre. The merchant city of the sea will be laid waste, her merchants who were princes will be dishonored, and for seventy years Tyre will be forgotten. After seventy years the LORD will visit Tyre and her merchandise shall be devoted to the LORD.

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| <p>1 <i>The burden of Tyre. Howl, ye ships of Tarshish; for it is laid waste, so that there is no house, no entering in: from the land of Chittim it is revealed to them.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Be still, ye inhabitants of the isle; thou whom the merchants of Zidon, that pass over the sea, have replenished.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And by great waters the seed of Sihor, the harvest of the river, is her revenue; and she is a mart of nations.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Be thou ashamed, O Zidon: for the sea hath spoken, even the strength of the sea, saying, I travail not, nor bring forth children, neither do I nourish up young men, nor bring up virgins.</i></p> <p>5 <i>As at the report concerning Egypt, so shall they be sorely pained at the report of Tyre.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Pass ye over to Tarshish; howl, ye inhabitants of the isle.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Is this your joyous city, whose antiquity is of ancient days? her own feet shall carry her afar off to sojourn.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Who hath taken this counsel against Tyre, the crowning city, whose merchants are princes, whose traffickers are the honourable of the earth?</i></p> | <p>The burden of Tyre. Wail, O ships of Tarshish, for Tyre is laid waste — without house or harbor! From the land of Cyprus this has been revealed to them.</p> <p>Be silent, O inhabitants of the coastland, You whom the merchants of Sidon crossing the sea have enriched.</p> <p>Over many waters came the grain of the Nile — the harvest of the River — and she was the marketplace of nations.</p> <p>Be ashamed, O Sidon, for the sea has spoken — the stronghold of the sea says, "I have neither labored nor given birth; I have not raised young men nor brought up young women."</p> <p>When the report reaches Egypt, they shall be in anguish over the report about Tyre.</p> <p>Cross over to Tarshish; wail, O inhabitants of the coastland!</p> <p>Is this Your joyful city, whose origin is from ancient days? Her feet shall carry her far away to stay in a distant land.</p> <p>Who has planned this against Tyre, the city that bestowed crowns, whose merchants were princes, whose traders were among the honored of the earth?</p> |
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- 9 *The LORD of hosts hath purposed it, to stain the pride of all glory, and to bring into contempt all the honourable of the earth.* The LORD of hosts has purposed it — to defile the pride of all glory, to dishonor all the honored of the earth.
- 10 *Pass through thy land as a river, O daughter of Tarshish: there is no more strength.* Cross Your land like the Nile, O daughter of Tarshish — there is no restraint anymore.
- 11 *He stretched out his hand over the sea, he shook the kingdoms: the LORD hath given a commandment against the merchant city, to destroy the strong holds thereof.* He has stretched His hand over the sea; He has shaken the kingdoms. The LORD has given command concerning Canaan to destroy her strongholds.
- 12 *And he said, Thou shalt no more rejoice, O thou oppressed virgin, daughter of Zidon: arise, pass over to Chittim; there also shalt thou have no rest.* He said, "You shall no longer exult, O oppressed virgin daughter of Sidon. Rise and cross over to Cyprus — even there You shall find no rest."
- 13 *Behold the land of the Chaldeans; this people was not, till the Assyrian founded it for them that dwell in the wilderness: they set up the towers thereof, they raised up the palaces thereof; and he brought it to ruin.* Look at the land of the Chaldeans — this people who were nothing! Assyria founded it for desert dwellers. They set up their siege towers, they stripped bare Tyre's palaces, and made it a ruin.
- 14 *Howl, ye ships of Tarshish: for your strength is laid waste.* Wail, O ships of Tarshish, for Your stronghold is laid waste!
- 15 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that Tyre shall be forgotten seventy years, according to the days of one king: after the end of seventy years shall Tyre sing as an harlot.* In that day Tyre will be forgotten for seventy years — the length of one king's life. At the end of seventy years, Tyre shall sing like a harlot.
- 16 *Take an harp, go about the city, thou harlot that hast been forgotten; make sweet melody, sing many songs, that thou mayest be remembered.* "Take a harp; go around the city, O forgotten harlot! Play sweetly, sing many songs, so that You may be remembered."

- 17 *And it shall come to pass after the end of seventy years, that the LORD will visit Tyre, and she shall turn to her hire, and shall commit fornication with all the kingdoms of the world upon the face of the earth.* At the end of seventy years, the LORD will visit Tyre. She shall return to her wages and prostitute herself with all the kingdoms of the world on the face of the earth.
- 18 *And her merchandise and her hire shall be holiness to the LORD: it shall not be treasured nor laid up; for her merchandise shall be for them that dwell before the LORD, to eat sufficiently, and for durable clothing.* Her profits and her wages shall be holy to the LORD. They shall not be stored or hoarded, but her gains shall go to those who live before the LORD — to eat their fill and wear fine clothing.

Words in this chapter:

Canaan (KAY-nan) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

v1 — Joel 3:4-8; Gen 10:4; Amos 1:9-10

v9 — Jas 4:6; Isa 13:11; Job 40:11-12; Isa 2:11

v15 — Jer 25:22

v17 — Nah 3:4

v18 — Ps 72:10

Chapter 24

The LORD will lay waste the whole earth, making it empty and turning it upside down. The earth mourns and the merry-hearted sigh. The earth is utterly broken down. The LORD of hosts shall reign in Mount Zion and in Jerusalem, and before His elders He will be glorified.

- 1 *Behold, the LORD maketh the earth empty, and maketh it waste, and turneth it upside down, and scattereth abroad the inhabitants thereof.* The LORD is making the earth empty and laying it waste. He is twisting its surface and scattering its inhabitants.

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| 2 | <i>And it shall be, as with the people, so with the priest; as with the servant, so with his master; as with the maid, so with her mistress; as with the buyer, so with the seller; as with the lender, so with the borrower; as with the taker of usury, so with the giver of usury to him.</i> | The same fate shall come on the people and the priest, the servant and his master, the maid and her mistress, the buyer and the seller, the lender and the borrower, the creditor and the debtor. |
| 3 | <i>The land shall be utterly emptied, and utterly spoiled: for the LORD hath spoken this word.</i> | The earth shall be utterly emptied and utterly plundered, for the LORD has spoken this word. |
| 4 | <i>The earth mourneth and fadeth away, the world languisheth and fadeth away, the haughty people of the earth do languish.</i> | The earth mourns and withers; the world fades and withers; the highest people of the earth fade away. |
| 5 | <i>The earth also is defiled under the inhabitants thereof; because they have transgressed the laws, changed the ordinance, broken the everlasting covenant.</i> | The earth is defiled by its inhabitants, for they have transgressed the laws, violated the statutes, and broken the everlasting covenant. |
| 6 | <i>Therefore hath the curse devoured the earth, and they that dwell therein are desolate: therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left.</i> | Therefore a curse devours the earth; its inhabitants suffer for their guilt.
Therefore the inhabitants of the earth are scorched, and few men are left. |
| 7 | <i>The new wine mourneth, the vine languisheth, all the merryhearted do sigh.</i> | The wine mourns; the vine fades. All the merry-hearted sigh. |
| 8 | <i>The mirth of tabrets ceaseth, the noise of them that rejoice endeth, the joy of the harp ceaseth.</i> | The joyful tambourines are stilled; the noise of the jubilant has ceased; the joyful harp is silent. |
| 9 | <i>They shall not drink wine with a song; strong drink shall be bitter to them that drink it.</i> | No longer do they drink wine with singing. Strong drink is bitter to those who drink it. |

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| 10 <i>The city of confusion is broken down: every house is shut up, that no man may come in.</i> | The city of chaos is broken down; every house is locked up so no one can enter. |
| 11 <i>There is a crying for wine in the streets; all joy is darkened, the mirth of the land is gone.</i> | There is an outcry in the streets for lack of wine; all joy has turned to gloom; the gladness of the earth is banished. |
| 12 <i>In the city is left desolation, and the gate is smitten with destruction.</i> | Desolation is left in the city; the gate is battered to ruins. |
| 13 <i>When thus it shall be in the midst of the land among the people, there shall be as the shaking of an olive tree, and as the gleaning grapes when the vintage is done.</i> | For so it shall be in the midst of the earth among the nations — as when an olive tree is beaten, as at the gleaning when the grape harvest is done. |
| 14 <i>They shall lift up their voice, they shall sing for the majesty of the LORD, they shall cry aloud from the sea.</i> | They lift up their voices; they sing for joy. Over the majesty of the LORD they shout from the west. |
| 15 <i>Wherefore glorify ye the LORD in the fires, even the name of the LORD God of Israel in the isles of the sea.</i> | Therefore in the east give glory to the LORD; in the coastlands of the sea, give glory to the name of the LORD, the God of Israel. |
| 16 <i>From the uttermost part of the earth have we heard songs, even glory to the righteous. But I said, My leanness, my leanness, woe unto me! the treacherous dealers have dealt treacherously; yea, the treacherous dealers have dealt very treacherously.</i> | From the ends of the earth we hear songs of praise — "Glory to the Righteous One!" But I say, "I am wasting away; I am wasting away! Woe to me! The treacherous deal treacherously; the treacherous deal very treacherously." |
| 17 <i>Fear, and the pit, and the snare, are upon thee, O inhabitant of the earth.</i> | Terror, pit, and snare are upon You, O inhabitant of the earth! |

- 18 *And it shall come to pass, that he who fleeth from the noise of the fear shall fall into the pit; and he that cometh up out of the midst of the pit shall be taken in the snare: for the windows from on high are open, and the foundations of the earth do shake.* Whoever flees at the sound of terror shall fall into the pit, and whoever climbs out of the pit shall be caught in the snare. For the windows from on high are opened, and the foundations of the earth tremble.
- 19 *The earth is utterly broken down, the earth is clean dissolved, the earth is moved exceedingly.* The earth is violently broken; the earth is split apart; the earth is shaken violently.
- 20 *The earth shall reel to and fro like a drunkard, and shall be removed like a cottage; and the transgression thereof shall be heavy upon it; and it shall fall, and not rise again.* The earth staggers like a drunkard; it sways like a hut. Its transgression lies heavy upon it; it falls and will not rise again.
- 21 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the LORD shall punish the host of the high ones that are on high, and the kings of the earth upon the earth.* In that day the LORD will punish the host of heaven in heaven, and the kings of the earth on the earth.
- 22 *And they shall be gathered together, as prisoners are gathered in the pit, and shall be shut up in the prison, and after many days shall they be visited.* They shall be gathered together as prisoners are gathered in a pit. They shall be shut up in a prison, and after many days they shall be punished.
- 23 *Then the moon shall be confounded, and the sun ashamed, when the LORD of hosts shall reign in mount Zion, and in Jerusalem, and before his ancients gloriously.* The moon shall be put to shame and the sun ashamed, for the LORD of hosts reigns on Mount Zion and in Jerusalem, and His glory is before His elders.

Words in this chapter:

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

transgression — Crossing the line God set — deliberately breaking a specific command He gave.

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 2:19; Nah 2:10; Isa 42:15; Isa 24:20
v2 — Hos 4:9
v3 — Isa 24:1
v5 — Heb 13:20; Rom 8:20-21
v6 — Mal 4:1
v8 — Hos 2:11
v16 — Isa 21:2
v18 — Ps 18:7; Gen 7:11
v20 — Isa 19:14; Dan 11:19; Isa 29:9
v21 — Ps 76:12; Zech 14:12-19; Isa 34:2-17
v22 — Zech 9:11
v23 — Isa 60:19; Rev 21:23; Isa 13:10; Rev 22:5

Chapter 25

Isaiah praises the LORD for His wonderful works and faithful counsels. The LORD will make a feast of rich food for all peoples on this mountain and will swallow up death forever. He will wipe away tears from all faces and remove the disgrace of His people.

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| <p>1 <i>O LORD, thou art my God; I will exalt thee, I will praise thy name; for thou hast done wonderful things; thy counsels of old are faithfulness and truth.</i></p> | <p>O LORD, You are my God. I will exalt You; I will praise Your name. For You have done wonderful things — plans formed long ago, faithful and sure.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For thou hast made of a city an heap; of a defenced city a ruin: a palace of strangers to be no city; it shall never be built.</i></p> | <p>For You have made a city a heap of rubble, a fortified city a ruin — a palace of foreigners to be a city no more. It shall never be rebuilt.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Therefore shall the strong people glorify thee, the city of the terrible nations shall fear thee.</i></p> | <p>Therefore strong peoples will glorify You; cities of ruthless nations shall fear You.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For thou hast been a strength to the poor, a strength to the needy in his distress, a refuge from the storm, a shadow from the heat, when the blast of the terrible ones is as a storm against the wall.</i></p> | <p>For You have been a stronghold to the poor, a stronghold to the needy in His distress, a shelter from the storm and a shade from the heat. When the blast of the ruthless was like a storm against a wall,</p> |

- 5 *Thou shalt bring down the noise of strangers, as the heat in a dry place; even the heat with the shadow of a cloud: the branch of the terrible ones shall be brought low.* You subdued the noise of foreigners — like heat in a dry place — with the shadow of a cloud. The song of the ruthless was silenced.
- 6 *And in this mountain shall the LORD of hosts make unto all people a feast of fat things, a feast of wines on the lees, of fat things full of marrow, of wines on the lees well refined.* On this mountain the LORD of hosts will prepare for all peoples a feast of rich food — a feast of aged wine, of rich food full of marrow, of aged wine well refined.
- 7 *And he will destroy in this mountain the face of the covering cast over all people, and the vail that is spread over all nations.* He will swallow up on this mountain the covering that is cast over all peoples, the veil that is spread over all nations.
- 8 *He will swallow up death in victory; and the Lord GOD will wipe away tears from off all faces; and the rebuke of his people shall he take away from off all the earth: for the LORD hath spoken it.* He will swallow up death in victory. The Lord GOD will wipe away tears from all faces, and the reproach of His people He will take away from all the earth. The LORD has spoken.
- 9 *And it shall be said in that day, Lo, this is our God; we have waited for him, and he will save us: this is the LORD; we have waited for him, we will be glad and rejoice in his salvation.* It shall be said in that day, "This is our God; we have waited for Him, and He has saved us. This is the LORD; we have waited for Him. Let us be glad and rejoice in His salvation."
- 10 *For in this mountain shall the hand of the LORD rest, and Moab shall be trodden down under him, even as straw is trodden down for the dunghill.* For the hand of the LORD shall rest on this mountain, and Moab shall be trampled down in His place — as straw is trampled down in a manure pile.

- 11 *And he shall spread forth his hands in the midst of them, as he that swimmeth spreadeth forth his hands to swim: and he shall bring down their pride together with the spoils of their hands.* He shall spread out His hands in the midst of it, as a swimmer spreads His hands to swim. His pride shall be laid low together with the skill of His hands.
- 12 *And the fortress of the high fort of thy walls shall he bring down, lay low, and bring to the ground, even to the dust.* The high fortifications of Your walls He will bring down, lay low, and cast to the ground — to the dust.

Words in this chapter:

vail — The thick curtain separating the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle — torn from top to bottom at Christ's death, opening the way to God.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ex 15:2; Ps 118:28; Num 23:19; Ps 98:1; Ps 40:5
v4 — Zeph 3:12; Jas 2:5; Isa 32:2; Matt 7:25-27; Ps 12:5
v6 — Matt 8:11; Ps 63:5; Zech 9:16-17; Jer 31:12-13; Luke 22:30
v7 — Eph 4:18; Isa 60:1-3; Matt 27:51; 2 Cor 3:13-18; Heb 10:19-21
v8 — Rev 21:4; Rev 7:17; 1 Cor 15:54; Hos 13:14; 1 Cor 15:26
v9 — Ps 27:14; Gen 49:18; Mic 7:7; Isa 26:8-9; Ps 20:5
v11 — Isa 16:14; Isa 16:6; Isa 5:25; Isa 14:26; Isa 2:11

Chapter 26

Isaiah sings a song of the strong city -- salvation is appointed for walls and bulwarks. The righteous nation that keeps the truth shall enter in. The LORD is the everlasting rock who brings down the lofty city. Isaiah longs for the LORD in the night and declares that the dead shall live and the earth shall cast out the dead.

- 1 *In that day shall this song be sung in the land of Judah; We have a strong city; salvation will God appoint for walls and bulwarks.* In that day this song shall be sung in the land of Judah: "We have a strong city. God appoints salvation as walls and ramparts.
- 2 *Open ye the gates, that the righteous nation which keepeth the truth may enter in.* Open the gates, so the righteous nation that keeps faith may enter in.

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| <p>3 <i>Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee: because he trusteth in thee.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Trust ye in the LORD for ever: for in the LORD JEHOVAH is everlasting strength:</i></p> <p>5 <i>For he bringeth down them that dwell on high; the lofty city, he layeth it low; he layeth it low, even to the ground; he bringeth it even to the dust.</i></p> <p>6 <i>The foot shall tread it down, even the feet of the poor, and the steps of the needy.</i></p> <p>7 <i>The way of the just is uprightness: thou, most upright, dost weigh the path of the just.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Yea, in the way of thy judgments, O LORD, have we waited for thee; the desire of our soul is to thy name, and to the remembrance of thee.</i></p> <p>9 <i>With my soul have I desired thee in the night; yea, with my spirit within me will I seek thee early: for when thy judgments are in the earth, the inhabitants of the world will learn righteousness.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Let favour be shewed to the wicked, yet will he not learn righteousness: in the land of uprightness will he deal unjustly, and will not behold the majesty of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>You keep Him in perfect peace whose mind is stayed on You, because He trusts in You.</p> <p>Trust in the LORD forever, for the LORD JEHOVAH is an everlasting rock.</p> <p>For He brings down those who dwell on high; He lays the lofty city low — lays it low to the ground, casts it to the dust.</p> <p>The foot shall trample it — the feet of the poor and the steps of the humble.</p> <p>The path of the righteous is level. You, who are upright, make the way of the righteous smooth.</p> <p>In the path of Your judgments, O LORD, we wait for You. Your name and Your remembrance are the desire of our soul.</p> <p>My soul yearns for You in the night; my spirit within me earnestly seeks You. For when Your judgments are in the earth, the inhabitants of the world learn righteousness.</p> <p>If favor is shown to the wicked, he does not learn righteousness. Even in the land of uprightness He deals corruptly and does not see the majesty of the LORD.</p> |
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- 11 *LORD, when thy hand is lifted up, they will not see: but they shall see, and be ashamed for their envy at the people; yea, the fire of thine enemies shall devour them.* O LORD, Your hand is lifted up, but they do not see it. Let them see Your zeal for Your people and be ashamed. Let fire for Your adversaries consume them.
- 12 *LORD, thou wilt ordain peace for us: for thou also hast wrought all our works in us.* O LORD, You will ordain peace for us, for You have also done all our works for us.
- 13 *O LORD our God, other lords beside thee have had dominion over us: but by thee only will we make mention of thy name.* O LORD our God, other lords besides You have ruled over us, but we acknowledge Your name alone.
- 14 *They are dead, they shall not live; they are deceased, they shall not rise: therefore hast thou visited and destroyed them, and made all their memory to perish.* The dead do not live; departed spirits do not rise. You have punished them and destroyed them; You have wiped out all memory of them.
- 15 *Thou hast increased the nation, O LORD, thou hast increased the nation: thou art glorified: thou hadst removed it far unto all the ends of the earth.* You have increased the nation, O LORD; You have increased the nation. You are glorified. You have extended all the borders of the land.
- 16 *LORD, in trouble have they visited thee, they poured out a prayer when thy chastening was upon them.* O LORD, in distress they sought You; they poured out a whispered prayer when Your discipline was on them.
- 17 *Like as a woman with child, that draweth near the time of her delivery, is in pain, and crieth out in her pangs; so have we been in thy sight, O LORD.* Like a pregnant woman who writhes and cries out in her pangs when she is near to giving birth, so were we before You, O LORD.

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| <p>18 <i>We have been with child, we have been in pain, we have as it were brought forth wind; we have not wrought any deliverance in the earth; neither have the inhabitants of the world fallen.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise. Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust: for thy dew is as the dew of herbs, and the earth shall cast out the dead.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Come, my people, enter thou into thy chambers, and shut thy doors about thee: hide thyself as it were for a little moment, until the indignation be overpast.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For, behold, the LORD cometh out of his place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity: the earth also shall disclose her blood, and shall no more cover her slain.</i></p> | <p>We were pregnant; we writhed — but we gave birth to wind. We have accomplished no deliverance in the earth, and the inhabitants of the world have not fallen.</p> <p>Your dead shall live; their bodies shall rise. You who dwell in the dust, awake and sing for joy! For Your dew is a dew of light, and the earth will give birth to the dead.</p> <p>Come, my people, enter Your rooms and shut Your doors behind You. Hide for a little while until the fury has passed by.</p> <p>For the LORD is coming out of His place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity. The earth will disclose the blood shed on her; she will no longer cover her slain.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 62:11; Zech 2:5; Isa 60:18; Eph 5:19-20
v2 — Rev 5:9; 1 Pet 2:9; Isa 60:11; Ps 118:20; Isa 62:10
v3 — Phil 4:7; John 16:33; John 14:27; Jer 17:7-8; Ps 9:10
v4 — Isa 12:2; Ps 62:8; Ps 55:22; Phil 4:13; Ps 18:2
v5 — Rev 18:2; Job 40:11-13; Jer 51:37
v7 — Eph 2:10; Isa 42:16; 1 John 3:7; 1 John 3:10; 2 Cor 1:12
v8 — Jas 5:7-11; Ps 37:3-7; Isa 33:2
v9 — Matt 6:33; Ps 119:62; Ps 63:1; Song 3:1-4; Ps 63:6-7
v12 — Eph 2:10; Ps 57:2; Ps 29:11; Ezek 20:14
v19 — Dan 12:2; Ezek 37:1-14; Matt 27:52; Eph 5:14; Hos 13:14
v20 — Ps 30:5; Ps 27:5; Isa 54:7-8; Matt 6:6; Ps 91:4

v21 — Rev 6:9-11; Isa 13:11; Jude 1:14-15; Job 16:18; Isa 18:4

Chapter 27

In that day the LORD will punish leviathan the fleeing serpent with His great sword. He will keep His vineyard, watering it every moment. Jacob's iniquity will be purged when the altar stones are crushed, and in that day a great trumpet will sound and the outcasts of Israel will worship the LORD in Jerusalem.

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| <p>1 <i>In that day the LORD with his sore and great and strong sword shall punish leviathan the piercing serpent, even leviathan that crooked serpent; and he shall slay the dragon that is in the sea.</i></p> | <p>In that day the LORD with His hard and great and strong sword will punish Leviathan the fleeing serpent — Leviathan the twisting serpent — and He will slay the dragon that is in the sea.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>In that day sing ye unto her, A vineyard of red wine.</i></p> | <p>In that day, "A pleasant vineyard — sing of it!</p> |
| <p>3 <i>I the LORD do keep it; I will water it every moment: lest any hurt it, I will keep it night and day.</i></p> | <p>I, the LORD, am its keeper; every moment I water it. Lest anyone harm it, I keep it night and day.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Fury is not in me: who would set the briers and thorns against me in battle? I would go through them, I would burn them together.</i></p> | <p>I have no fury. If briers and thorns confront Me in battle, I will march against them and burn them up together.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Or let him take hold of my strength, that he may make peace with me; and he shall make peace with me.</i></p> | <p>Or let them take hold of My protection; let them make peace with Me — let them make peace with Me."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>He shall cause them that come of Jacob to take root: Israel shall blossom and bud, and fill the face of the world with fruit.</i></p> | <p>In days to come Jacob shall take root; Israel shall blossom and put forth shoots and fill the whole world with fruit.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Hath he smitten him, as he smote those that smote him? or is he slain according to the slaughter of them that are slain by him?</i></p> | <p>Has He struck them as He struck those who struck them? Or have they been slain as their slayers were slain?</p> |

- 8 *In measure, when it shooteth forth, thou wilt debate with it: he stayeth his rough wind in the day of the east wind.* Measure by measure, by exile, You contended with them. He removed them with His fierce wind on the day of the east wind.
- 9 *By this therefore shall the iniquity of Jacob be purged; and this is all the fruit to take away his sin; when he maketh all the stones of the altar as chalkstones that are beaten in sunder, the groves and images shall not stand up.* By this the iniquity of Jacob shall be forgiven — this is the full fruit of removing his sin — when he makes all the altar stones like crushed chalk, so that the groves and images shall not stand up.
- 10 *Yet the defenced city shall be desolate, and the habitation forsaken, and left like a wilderness: there shall the calf feed, and there shall he lie down, and consume the branches thereof.* For the fortified city is alone, a deserted settlement, abandoned like a wilderness. Calves graze there; there they lie down and strip its branches.
- 11 *When the boughs thereof are withered, they shall be broken off: the women come, and set them on fire: for it is a people of no understanding: therefore he that made them will not have mercy on them, and he that formed them will shew them no favour.* When its branches wither, they are broken off; women come and make a fire with them. For this is a people without understanding; therefore He who made them will not have mercy on them, and he who formed them will show them no favor.
- 12 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the LORD shall beat off from the channel of the river unto the stream of Egypt, and ye shall be gathered one by one, O ye children of Israel.* In that day the LORD will thresh from the channel of the Euphrates to the Brook of Egypt, and You will be gathered one by one, O people of Israel.

- 13 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the great trumpet shall be blown, and they shall come which were ready to perish in the land of Assyria, and the outcasts in the land of Egypt, and shall worship the LORD in the holy mount at Jerusalem.* In that day a great trumpet shall be blown, and those who were perishing in Assyria and those who were driven out to Egypt shall come and worship the LORD on the holy mountain at Jerusalem.

Words in this chapter:

leviathan (*leh-VY-ah-than*) — A great sea creature described in Job 41 — powerful and fearsome; used as a symbol of chaos that only God can subdue.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 66:16; Ezek 29:3; Isa 51:9; Rev 12:3-13:2; Rev 20:2

v3 — Isa 58:11; John 15:1-2; 1 Sam 2:9; Ps 121:3-5; Ezek 34:11

v4 — Isa 10:17; Heb 6:8

v5 — Isa 25:4; Job 22:21

v6 — Isa 37:31; Hos 14:5-6

v12 — Gen 15:18

v13 — Matt 24:31; Lev 25:9; Heb 12:22; Isa 19:23-25

Chapter 28

The LORD pronounces woe to the drunkards of Ephraim whose glorious beauty is a fading flower. He will lay in Zion a tried stone, a precious corner stone, a sure foundation. He rebukes the scornful rulers of Jerusalem who have made a covenant with death, declaring that their agreement with hell shall not stand.

- 1 *Woe to the crown of pride, to the drunkards of Ephraim, whose glorious beauty is a fading flower, which are on the head of the fat valleys of them that are overcome with wine!* Woe to the proud crown of Ephraim's drunkards, and to the fading flower of their glorious beauty — set on the head of the rich valley of those overcome with wine!

- 2 *Behold, the Lord hath a mighty and strong one, which as a tempest of hail and a destroying storm, as a flood of mighty waters overflowing, shall cast down to the earth with the hand.* The Lord has one who is mighty and strong. Like a storm of hail, a destroying tempest — like a flood of mighty waters overflowing — He casts down to the earth with violence.
- 3 *The crown of pride, the drunkards of Ephraim, shall be trodden under feet:* The proud crown of Ephraim's drunkards shall be trampled underfoot.
- 4 *And the glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fat valley, shall be a fading flower, and as the hasty fruit before the summer; which when he that looketh upon it seeth, while it is yet in his hand he eateth it up.* The fading flower of their glorious beauty set on the head of the rich valley shall be like a first-ripe fig before the summer. Whoever sees it swallows it as soon as it is in his hand.
- 5 *In that day shall the LORD of hosts be for a crown of glory, and for a diadem of beauty, unto the residue of his people,* In that day the LORD of hosts shall be a crown of glory and a diadem of beauty to the remnant of His people,
- 6 *And for a spirit of judgment to him that sitteth in judgment, and for strength to them that turn the battle to the gate.* a spirit of justice to Him who sits in judgment, and strength to those who turn back the battle at the gate.
- 7 *But they also have erred through wine, and through strong drink are out of the way; the priest and the prophet have erred through strong drink, they are swallowed up of wine, they are out of the way through strong drink; they err in vision, they stumble in judgment.* These also reel with wine and stagger with strong drink — priest and prophet reel with strong drink; they are overcome by wine. They stagger when seeing visions; they stumble when giving judgment.
- 8 *For all tables are full of vomit and filthiness, so that there is no place clean.* All their tables are covered with vomit; not a spot is clean.

- 9 *Whom shall he teach knowledge? and whom shall he make to understand doctrine? them that are weaned from the milk, and drawn from the breasts.* "To whom will He teach knowledge, and to whom will He explain the message? Those just weaned from milk, those just taken from the breast?
- 10 *For precept must be upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; here a little, and there a little:* For it is precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little."
- 11 *For with stammering lips and another tongue will he speak to this people.* For by people of strange lips and with a foreign tongue the LORD will speak to this people,
- 12 *To whom he said, This is the rest wherewith ye may cause the weary to rest; and this is the refreshing: yet they would not hear.* to whom He had said, "This is rest; give rest to the weary. This is refreshing." But they would not hear.
- 13 *But the word of the LORD was unto them precept upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; here a little, and there a little; that they might go, and fall backward, and be broken, and snared, and taken.* The word of the LORD shall be to them precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little — so that they may go, stumble backward, be broken, snared, and taken.
- 14 *Wherefore hear the word of the LORD, ye scornful men, that rule this people which is in Jerusalem.* Therefore, hear the word of the LORD, You scoffers, who rule this people in Jerusalem!
- 15 *Because ye have said, We have made a covenant with death, and with hell are we at agreement; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, it shall not come unto us: for we have made lies our refuge, and under falsehood have we hid ourselves:* Because You have said, "We have made a covenant with death, and with hell we are in agreement. When the overwhelming scourge passes through, it will not come to us, for we have made lies our refuge, and in falsehood we have taken shelter,"

- 16 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious corner stone, a sure foundation: he that believeth shall not make haste.* therefore thus says the Lord GOD: "I am laying in Zion a stone — a tested stone, a precious cornerstone, a sure foundation. Whoever believes will not be in a hurry.
- 17 *Judgment also will I lay to the line, and righteousness to the plummet: and the hail shall sweep away the refuge of lies, and the waters shall overflow the hiding place.* I will make justice the measuring line and righteousness the plumb line. Hail will sweep away the refuge of lies, and waters shall overflow the hiding place.
- 18 *And your covenant with death shall be disannulled, and your agreement with hell shall not stand; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, then ye shall be trodden down by it.* Your covenant with death will be annulled, and Your agreement with hell shall not stand. When the overwhelming scourge passes through, You will be beaten down by it.
- 19 *From the time that it goeth forth it shall take you: for morning by morning shall it pass over, by day and by night: and it shall be a vexation only to understand the report.* As often as it passes through, it shall take You — morning by morning, by day and by night — and it shall be sheer terror to understand the message.
- 20 *For the bed is shorter than that a man can stretch himself on it: and the covering narrower than that he can wrap himself in it.* For the bed is too short to stretch out on, and the cover too narrow to wrap oneself in.
- 21 *For the LORD shall rise up as in mount Perazim, he shall be wroth as in the valley of Gibeon, that he may do his work, his strange work; and bring to pass his act, his strange act.* For the LORD will rise up as on Mount Perazim; He will be roused as in the Valley of Gibeon. He will do His work — His strange work — and perform His task — His alien task.
- 22 *Now therefore be ye not mockers, lest your bands be made strong: for I have heard from the Lord GOD of hosts a consumption, even determined upon the whole earth.* Now therefore do not mock, lest Your bonds be made strong. For I have heard a decree of destruction from the Lord GOD of hosts against the whole earth.

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| <p>23 <i>Give ye ear, and hear my voice; hearken, and hear my speech.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Doth the plowman plow all day to sow? doth he open and break the clods of his ground?</i></p> <p>25 <i>When he hath made plain the face thereof, doth he not cast abroad the fitches, and scatter the cummin, and cast in the principal wheat and the appointed barley and the rie in their place?</i></p> <p>26 <i>For his God doth instruct him to discretion, and doth teach him.</i></p> <p>27 <i>For the fitches are not threshed with a threshing instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned about upon the cummin; but the fitches are beaten out with a staff, and the cummin with a rod.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Bread corn is bruised; because he will not ever be threshing it, nor break it with the wheel of his cart, nor bruise it with his horsemen.</i></p> <p>29 <i>This also cometh forth from the LORD of hosts, which is wonderful in counsel, and excellent in working.</i></p> | <p>Give ear and hear my voice; listen and hear my speech.</p> <p>Does the farmer plow all day just to plant? Does He keep opening and breaking up the soil?</p> <p>When He has leveled its surface, does He not scatter dill and sow cumin, plant wheat in rows and barley in its proper place, and spelt as its border?</p> <p>His God instructs Him and teaches Him the right way.</p> <p>Dill is not threshed with a threshing sledge, nor is a cart wheel rolled over cumin. But dill is beaten with a stick and cumin with a rod.</p> <p>Grain must be crushed. One does not thresh it forever. A cart wheel and horses may be driven over it, but it is not crushed.</p> <p>This also comes from the LORD of hosts. He is wonderful in counsel and great in wisdom.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

- v5 — 1 Pet 5:4; Isa 60:19; Isa 62:3; Rom 11:5-6
- v6 — Ps 18:32-34; John 5:30; Isa 11:2-4; Num 11:16-17; Josh 1:9
- v7 — Luke 21:34; Isa 56:10-12
- v9 — Ps 131:2; Jer 6:10; John 12:38; Matt 11:25; Matt 21:15-16

- v10** — Isa 28:13; 2 Tim 3:7; Jer 11:7; Jer 25:3-7
v11 — 1 Cor 14:21; Deut 28:49; Jer 5:15; Isa 33:19
v12 — Matt 11:28-29; Isa 30:15; Jer 6:16; Heb 12:25; Jer 44:16
v13 — Matt 13:14; Isa 6:9-10
v16 — Ps 118:22; Acts 4:11-12; 1 Pet 2:6-8; Luke 20:17-18; Rom 9:33
v18 — Isa 7:7; Isa 8:10; Isa 28:15
v21 — 1 Chr 14:11; 2 Sam 5:20; Josh 10:12; Josh 10:10
v29 — Rom 11:33; Job 5:9; Jer 32:19; Isa 9:6; Ps 40:5

Chapter 29

The LORD pronounces woe to Ariel -- Jerusalem -- which He will besiege and bring low, yet the multitude of her enemies will be like a dream that vanishes. He rebukes those who seek to hide their plans from the LORD and those whose worship is mere lip service while their hearts are far from Him. Lebanon shall become a fruitful field and the deaf shall hear and the blind shall see.

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| 1 <i>Woe to Ariel, to Ariel, the city where David dwelt! add ye year to year; let them kill sacrifices.</i> | Woe to Ariel — Ariel, the city where David camped! Add year to year; let the feasts run their cycle. |
| 2 <i>Yet I will distress Ariel, and there shall be heaviness and sorrow: and it shall be unto me as Ariel.</i> | Yet I will distress Ariel, and there shall be mourning and lamentation. She shall be to Me like an altar hearth. |
| 3 <i>And I will camp against thee round about, and will lay siege against thee with a mount, and I will raise forts against thee.</i> | I will encamp against you all around; I will besiege you with towers and raise siegeworks against you. |
| 4 <i>And thou shalt be brought down, and shalt speak out of the ground, and thy speech shall be low out of the dust, and thy voice shall be, as of one that hath a familiar spirit, out of the ground, and thy speech shall whisper out of the dust.</i> | Brought down, you shall speak from the ground; your words shall come from the dust. Your voice shall be like a ghost's from the ground; from the dust your speech shall whisper. |
| 5 <i>Moreover the multitude of thy strangers shall be like small dust, and the multitude of the terrible ones shall be as chaff that passeth away: yea, it shall be at an instant suddenly.</i> | But the crowd of your foes shall be like fine dust, and the crowd of the ruthless like passing chaff. It shall happen suddenly, in an instant. |

- 6 *Thou shalt be visited of the LORD of hosts with thunder, and with earthquake, and great noise, with storm and tempest, and the flame of devouring fire.* You shall be visited by the LORD of hosts with thunder, earthquake, and great noise — with whirlwind, tempest, and the flame of devouring fire.
- 7 *And the multitude of all the nations that fight against Ariel, even all that fight against her and her munition, and that distress her, shall be as a dream of a night vision.* The crowd of all the nations that fight against Ariel — all who fight against her and her stronghold and distress her — shall be like a dream, a vision of the night.
- 8 *It shall even be as when a hungry man dreameth, and, behold, he eateth; but he awaketh, and his soul is empty: or as when a thirsty man dreameth, and, behold, he drinketh; but he awaketh, and, behold, he is faint, and his soul hath appetite: so shall the multitude of all the nations be, that fight against mount Zion.* It shall be like a hungry man who dreams He is eating — then wakes, and is still hungry — or like a thirsty man who dreams He is drinking — then wakes, and is still faint with thirst. So shall the crowd of all the nations be that fight against Mount Zion.
- 9 *Stay yourselves, and wonder; cry ye out, and cry: they are drunken, but not with wine; they stagger, but not with strong drink.* Pause and wonder — blind yourselves and be blind! They are drunk, but not with wine; they stagger, but not from strong drink.
- 10 *For the LORD hath poured out upon you the spirit of deep sleep, and hath closed your eyes: the prophets and your rulers, the seers hath he covered.* For the LORD has poured out on You a spirit of deep sleep. He has closed Your eyes — the prophets — and covered Your heads — the seers.
- 11 *And the vision of all is become unto you as the words of a book that is sealed, which men deliver to one that is learned, saying, Read this, I pray thee: and he saith, I cannot; for it is sealed:* The vision of all this has become to You like the words of a sealed book. When people give it to one who can read and say, "Read this," he says, "I cannot, for it is sealed."

- 12 *And the book is delivered to him that is not learned, saying, Read this, I pray thee: and he saith, I am not learned.* When they give it to one who cannot read and say, "Read this," he says, "I cannot read."
- 13 *Wherefore the Lord said, Forasmuch as this people draw near me with their mouth, and with their lips do honour me, but have removed their heart far from me, and their fear toward me is taught by the precept of men:* The Lord said: "Because this people draw near to Me with their mouth and honor Me with their lips, while their hearts are far from Me, and their fear of Me is a commandment taught by men,
- 14 *Therefore, behold, I will proceed to do a marvellous work among this people, even a marvellous work and a wonder: for the wisdom of their wise men shall perish, and the understanding of their prudent men shall be hid.* therefore I will again do a marvelous work among this people — a marvelous work and a wonder. The wisdom of their wise men shall perish, and the understanding of their discerning men shall be hidden."
- 15 *Woe unto them that seek deep to hide their counsel from the LORD, and their works are in the dark, and they say, Who seeth us? and who knoweth us?* Woe to those who go to great depths to hide their plans from the LORD, Who do their deeds in the dark and say, "Who sees us? Who knows us?"
- 16 *Surely your turning of things upside down shall be esteemed as the potter's clay: for shall the work say of him that made it, He made me not? or shall the thing framed say of him that framed it, He had no understanding?* You turn things upside down! Shall the potter be regarded as the clay — that the thing made should say of its maker, "He did not make me," or the thing formed say of Him who formed it, "He has no understanding"?
- 17 *Is it not yet a very little while, and Lebanon shall be turned into a fruitful field, and the fruitful field shall be esteemed as a forest?* Is it not yet a very little while until Lebanon shall be turned into a fruitful field, and the fruitful field shall be regarded as a forest?

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| <p>18 <i>And in that day shall the deaf hear the words of the book, and the eyes of the blind shall see out of obscurity, and out of darkness.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The meek also shall increase their joy in the LORD, and the poor among men shall rejoice in the Holy One of Israel.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For the terrible one is brought to nought, and the scorner is consumed, and all that watch for iniquity are cut off:</i></p> <p>21 <i>That make a man an offender for a word, and lay a snare for him that reproveth in the gate, and turn aside the just for a thing of nought.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD, who redeemed Abraham, concerning the house of Jacob, Jacob shall not now be ashamed, neither shall his face now wax pale.</i></p> <p>23 <i>But when he seeth his children, the work of mine hands, in the midst of him, they shall sanctify my name, and sanctify the Holy One of Jacob, and shall fear the God of Israel.</i></p> <p>24 <i>They also that erred in spirit shall come to understanding, and they that murmured shall learn doctrine.</i></p> | <p>In that day the deaf shall hear the words of a book, and out of their gloom and darkness the eyes of the blind shall see.</p> <p>The humble shall obtain fresh joy in the LORD, and the poor among mankind shall exult in the Holy One of Israel.</p> <p>For the ruthless shall come to nothing and the scoffer shall cease; and all who watch for evil shall be cut off —</p> <p>those who make a man out to be a criminal by a word, who lay a snare for the one who argues justly at the gate, and who push aside the innocent with empty arguments.</p> <p>Therefore thus says the LORD, Who redeemed Abraham, concerning the house of Jacob: "Jacob shall no longer be ashamed; no longer shall his face grow pale.</p> <p>For when He sees His children — the work of My hands — in His midst, they shall sanctify My name. They shall sanctify the Holy One of Jacob and stand in awe of the God of Israel.</p> <p>Those who go astray in spirit will come to understanding, and those who grumble will accept instruction."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v4 — Isa 8:19; Ps 44:25
- v6 — Mark 13:8; Matt 24:7; 1 Sam 2:10; Rev 11:19; Rev 16:18
- v9 — Isa 51:21-22; Isa 49:26; Rev 17:6; Isa 33:13-14; Isa 19:14
- v10 — Rom 11:8; Isa 44:18; 2 Thess 2:9-12; Acts 28:26-27; Isa 30:10
- v11 — Matt 13:11; Isa 8:16; Dan 12:4
- v13 — Jer 12:2; Ezek 33:31-33; Mark 7:2-13; Matt 15:2-9; Jer 3:10
- v14 — Hab 1:5; 1 Cor 1:19-24; Isa 28:21; John 9:39-41; Jer 49:7
- v15 — Ezek 8:12; Isa 47:10; Isa 30:1; Ps 94:7-9; Ezek 9:9
- v16 — Rom 9:19-21; Isa 64:8; Isa 45:9-11; Ps 94:8-9; Jer 18:1-10
- v18 — Matt 11:5; Isa 35:5; Prov 20:12; Eph 1:17-19; Isa 32:3
- v19 — Jas 2:5; Isa 61:1; Matt 11:29; Matt 11:5; Ps 25:9
- v22 — Isa 51:2; Jer 30:10; Isa 45:17

Chapter 30

The LORD rebukes Judah for going down to Egypt for help and trusting in Pharaoh's shadow rather than in the LORD. He declares that in returning and rest they shall be saved, and in quietness and confidence shall be their strength, but they would not. The LORD will be gracious and will wait to show them mercy, and He will destroy Assyria with His voice.

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| 1 | <i>Woe to the rebellious children, saith the LORD, that take counsel, but not of me; and that cover with a covering, but not of my spirit, that they may add sin to sin:</i> | "Woe to the rebellious children," says the LORD, "who carry out plans that are not Mine, who make alliances, but not in My Spirit — adding sin to sin. |
| 2 | <i>That walk to go down into Egypt, and have not asked at my mouth; to strengthen themselves in the strength of Pharaoh, and to trust in the shadow of Egypt!</i> | They go down to Egypt without asking Me, to take refuge in the protection of Pharaoh and seek shelter in the shadow of Egypt! |
| 3 | <i>Therefore shall the strength of Pharaoh be your shame, and the trust in the shadow of Egypt your confusion.</i> | The protection of Pharaoh shall become your shame, and the shelter in Egypt's shadow your disgrace. |
| 4 | <i>For his princes were at Zoan, and his ambassadors came to Hanes.</i> | For their princes are at Zoan and their envoys reach Hanes. |

- 5 *They were all ashamed of a people that could not profit them, nor be an help nor profit, but a shame, and also a reproach.* Everyone shall be ashamed because of a people that cannot profit them — that brings neither help nor benefit, but only shame and disgrace."
- 6 *The burden of the beasts of the south: into the land of trouble and anguish, from whence come the young and old lion, the viper and fiery flying serpent, they will carry their riches upon the shoulders of young asses, and their treasures upon the bunches of camels, to a people that shall not profit them.* The burden of the beasts of the south: through a land of trouble and anguish, of the young and old lion, the viper and fiery flying serpent — they carry their riches on the backs of young donkeys and their treasures on the humps of camels, to a people that cannot profit them.
- 7 *For the Egyptians shall help in vain, and to no purpose: therefore have I cried concerning this, Their strength is to sit still.* Egypt's help is useless and empty; therefore I have called her "Rahab who sits still."
- 8 *Now go, write it before them in a table, and note it in a book, that it may be for the time to come for ever and ever:* Now go, write it on a tablet before them; inscribe it in a book so it may be for the coming days, as a witness forever and ever.
- 9 *That this is a rebellious people, lying children, children that will not hear the law of the LORD:* For it is a rebellious people — lying children who will not hear the instruction of the LORD,
- 10 *Which say to the seers, See not; and to the prophets, Prophecy not unto us right things, speak unto us smooth things, prophesy deceits:* who say to the seers, "Do not see," and to the prophets, "Do not prophesy to us what is right. Tell us pleasing things; prophesy illusions.
- 11 *Get you out of the way, turn aside out of the path, cause the Holy One of Israel to cease from before us.* Leave the way; turn aside from the path. Stop confronting us with the Holy One of Israel!"
- 12 *Wherefore thus saith the Holy One of Israel, Because ye despise this word, and trust in oppression and perverseness, and stay thereon:* Therefore thus says the Holy One of Israel: "Because You reject this word and trust in oppression and deceit and rely on them,

- 13 *Therefore this iniquity shall be to you as a breach ready to fall, swelling out in a high wall, whose breaking cometh suddenly at an instant.* this iniquity shall be to You like a breach in a high wall, bulging out and about to collapse — it breaks suddenly, in an instant.
- 14 *And he shall break it as the breaking of the potters' vessel that is broken in pieces; he shall not spare: so that there shall not be found in the bursting of it a sherd to take fire from the hearth, or to take water withal out of the pit.* It shall be broken like a potter's vessel that is smashed so ruthlessly that among its fragments no shard is found large enough to take fire from a hearth or scoop water from a cistern."
- 15 *For thus saith the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel; In returning and rest shall ye be saved; in quietness and in confidence shall be your strength: and ye would not.* For thus says the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel: "In returning and rest You shall be saved; in quietness and in confidence shall be Your strength." But You were unwilling.
- 16 *But ye said, No; for we will flee upon horses; therefore shall ye flee: and, We will ride upon the swift; therefore shall they that pursue you be swift.* You said, "No! We will flee on horses" — therefore You shall flee. "We will ride on swift horses" — therefore Your pursuers shall be swift.
- 17 *One thousand shall flee at the rebuke of one; at the rebuke of five shall ye flee: till ye be left as a beacon upon the top of a mountain, and as an ensign on an hill.* A thousand shall flee at the rebuke of one; at the rebuke of five You shall flee, until You are left like a flagstaff on the top of a mountain, like an ensign on a hill.
- 18 *And therefore will the LORD wait, that he may be gracious unto you, and therefore will he be exalted, that he may have mercy upon you: for the LORD is a God of judgment: blessed are all they that wait for him.* Therefore the LORD waits to be gracious to You; He rises to show You mercy. For the LORD is a God of judgment. Blessed are all those who wait for Him.

- 19 *For the people shall dwell in Zion at Jerusalem: thou shalt weep no more: he will be very gracious unto thee at the voice of thy cry; when he shall hear it, he will answer thee.* For a people shall dwell in Zion — in Jerusalem. You shall weep no more. He will surely be gracious to You at the sound of Your cry. When He hears it, He will answer You.
- 20 *And though the Lord give you the bread of adversity, and the water of affliction, yet shall not thy teachers be removed into a corner any more, but thine eyes shall see thy teachers:* Though the Lord gives You the bread of adversity and the water of affliction, Your Teacher will no longer hide Himself. Your eyes shall see Your Teacher.
- 21 *And thine ears shall hear a word behind thee, saying, This is the way, walk ye in it, when ye turn to the right hand, and when ye turn to the left.* Your ears shall hear a word behind You, saying, "This is the way, walk in it," when You turn to the right or when You turn to the left.
- 22 *Ye shall defile also the covering of thy graven images of silver, and the ornament of thy molten images of gold: thou shalt cast them away as a menstruous cloth; thou shalt say unto it, Get thee hence.* You shall defile Your carved idols overlaid with silver and Your gold-plated metal images. You shall scatter them like filthy rags. You shall say to them, "Be gone!"
- 23 *Then shall he give the rain of thy seed, that thou shalt sow the ground withal; and bread of the increase of the earth, and it shall be fat and plenteous: in that day shall thy cattle feed in large pastures.* He will give rain for the seed with which You sow the ground, and bread — the produce of the ground — will be rich and plentiful. In that day Your cattle will graze in broad pastures.
- 24 *The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.* The oxen and the donkeys that work the ground will eat good fodder — winnowed with shovel and fork.

- 25 *And there shall be upon every high mountain, and upon every high hill, rivers and streams of waters in the day of the great slaughter, when the towers fall.* On every high mountain and every high hill there shall be brooks running with water — in the day of the great slaughter, when the towers fall.
- 26 *Moreover the light of the moon shall be as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold, as the light of seven days, in the day that the LORD bindeth up the breach of his people, and healeth the stroke of their wound.* The light of the moon shall be as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold — like the light of seven days — in the day when the LORD binds up the brokenness of His people and heals the wounds He inflicted.
- 27 *Behold, the name of the LORD cometh from far, burning with his anger, and the burden thereof is heavy: his lips are full of indignation, and his tongue as a devouring fire:* The name of the LORD comes from afar, burning with His anger, heavy with cloud. His lips are full of fury, and His tongue is like a devouring fire.
- 28 *And his breath, as an overflowing stream, shall reach to the midst of the neck, to sift the nations with the sieve of vanity: and there shall be a bridle in the jaws of the people, causing them to err.* His breath is like an overflowing stream that reaches up to the neck — to sift the nations with the sieve of destruction, and to put a bridle on the jaws of the peoples that leads them astray.
- 29 *Ye shall have a song, as in the night when a holy solemnity is kept; and gladness of heart, as when one goeth with a pipe to come into the mountain of the LORD, to the mighty One of Israel.* You shall have a song as in the night when a holy feast is kept, and gladness of heart as when one sets out to the sound of the flute to go to the mountain of the LORD, to the Rock of Israel.

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| <p>30 <i>And the LORD shall cause his glorious voice to be heard, and shall shew the lighting down of his arm, with the indignation of his anger, and with the flame of a devouring fire, with scattering, and tempest, and hailstones.</i></p> <p>31 <i>For through the voice of the LORD shall the Assyrian be beaten down, which smote with a rod.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And in every place where the grounded staff shall pass, which the LORD shall lay upon him, it shall be with tabrets and harps: and in battles of shaking will he fight with it.</i></p> <p>33 <i>For Tophet is ordained of old; yea, for the king it is prepared; he hath made it deep and large: the pile thereof is fire and much wood; the breath of the LORD, like a stream of brimstone, doth kindle it.</i></p> | <p>The LORD will cause His majestic voice to be heard and show the descent of His arm — in furious anger — with consuming fire, with cloudburst, storm, and hailstones.</p> <p>For Assyria shall be terror-stricken at the voice of the LORD, when He strikes with His rod.</p> <p>Every stroke of the appointed staff that the LORD lays on them shall be to the sound of tambourines and harps. Battling with brandished fist, He fights them.</p> <p>For Topheth has long been prepared; it is made ready for the king. Its fire pit is made deep and wide, with plenty of fire and wood. The breath of the LORD, like a stream of sulfur, kindles it.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 65:2; Isa 1:2; Isa 63:10; Hos 7:13; Hos 4:10-12

v7 — Isa 2:22; Hos 5:13; Isa 7:4; Ps 118:8-9; Isa 31:1-5

v8 — Deut 31:22; Isa 8:1; Hab 2:2; Jer 36:2; Jer 36:28-32
v10 — Ezek 13:7-10; Rom 16:18; Amos 7:13; Amos 2:12; Jer 11:21
v15 — Isa 26:3-4; Isa 32:17; Jer 3:22-23; Ps 125:1-2; John 5:40
v17 — Deut 28:25; Lev 26:36; Josh 23:10; Deut 32:30
v18 — 2 Pet 3:9; Lam 3:25-26; Prov 16:20; Isa 25:9; Isa 8:17
v19 — Isa 60:20; Isa 65:24; Ps 50:15; Matt 7:7-11; Isa 58:9
v20 — 1 Kgs 22:27; Ps 80:5; Amos 8:11-12; Acts 14:22; Ps 127:2
v21 — Ps 32:8; Prov 3:5-6; Isa 58:11; Isa 42:16; Deut 5:32
v26 — Isa 60:19-20; Rev 22:5; Deut 32:39; Rev 21:23; Isa 24:23
v33 — 2 Kgs 23:10; Gen 19:24; Jer 19:6; 1 Pet 1:8; Heb 13:8

Chapter 31

The LORD pronounces woe on those who go down to Egypt for help, trusting in horses and chariots rather than looking to the Holy One of Israel. As a lion is not frightened by shepherds, so the LORD of hosts will come down to fight for Mount Zion. Assyria will fall by a sword not of man.

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| <p>1 <i>Woe to them that go down to Egypt for help; and stay on horses, and trust in chariots, because they are many; and in horsemen, because they are very strong; but they look not unto the Holy One of Israel, neither seek the LORD!</i></p> | <p>Woe to those who go down to Egypt for help and rely on horses, who trust in chariots because they are many and in horsemen because they are very strong — but they do not look to the Holy One of Israel, nor seek the LORD!</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Yet he also is wise, and will bring evil, and will not call back his words: but will arise against the house of the evildoers, and against the help of them that work iniquity.</i></p> | <p>Yet He also is wise and brings disaster; He does not take back His words. He will rise against the house of evildoers and against the helpers of those who do iniquity.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now the Egyptians are men, and not God; and their horses flesh, and not spirit. When the LORD shall stretch out his hand, both he that helpeth shall fall, and he that is holpen shall fall down, and they all shall fail together.</i></p> | <p>The Egyptians are man and not God; their horses are flesh and not spirit. When the LORD stretches out His hand, the helper will stumble and the one who is helped will fall, and they will all perish together.</p> |

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| <p>4 <i>For thus hath the LORD spoken unto me, Like as the lion and the young lion roaring on his prey, when a multitude of shepherds is called forth against him, he will not be afraid of their voice, nor abase himself for the noise of them: so shall the LORD of hosts come down to fight for mount Zion, and for the hill thereof.</i></p> <p>5 <i>As birds flying, so will the LORD of hosts defend Jerusalem; defending also he will deliver it; and passing over he will preserve it.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Turn ye unto him from whom the children of Israel have deeply revolted.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For in that day every man shall cast away his idols of silver, and his idols of gold, which your own hands have made unto you for a sin.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Then shall the Assyrian fall with the sword, not of a mighty man; and the sword, not of a mean man, shall devour him: but he shall flee from the sword, and his young men shall be discomfited.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And he shall pass over to his strong hold for fear, and his princes shall be afraid of the ensign, saith the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, and his furnace in Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>For thus the LORD said to me: "As a lion or a young lion growls over His prey, and when a band of shepherds is called out against Him He is not frightened by their shouting or disturbed by their noise — so the LORD of hosts will come down to fight on Mount Zion and on its hill."</p> <p>Like birds hovering, so the LORD of hosts will protect Jerusalem. He will protect and deliver it; He will spare and rescue it.</p> <p>Turn to Him from whom You have so deeply revolted, O children of Israel!</p> <p>For in that day everyone shall cast away His idols of silver and His idols of gold — which Your hands have sinfully made for You.</p> <p>And Assyria shall fall by a sword — not of man; a sword, not of mortals, shall devour Him. He shall flee from the sword, and His young men shall be put to forced labor.</p> <p>His rock shall pass away in terror, and His princes shall be panic-stricken at the ensign, declares the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, and whose furnace is in Jerusalem.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 20:7; Jer 17:5; Deut 17:16; Jer 2:13; Isa 36:9
- v2 — Num 23:19; Isa 45:7
- v3 — Ezek 20:33-34; Isa 9:17; Ps 9:20; Ezek 28:9; Ps 33:17
- v4 — Hos 11:10; Amos 3:8; Zech 2:5; Isa 42:13; Zech 12:8
- v5 — Ps 91:4; Ps 37:40
- v6 — Jer 3:22; Jer 3:14
- v7 — Isa 30:22; Isa 2:20

Chapter 32

Isaiah prophesies that a king will reign in righteousness and princes will rule in justice. Eyes that see will not be dim and ears that hear will listen. The careless women are warned that within a year they will tremble, for the harvest will fail. When the Spirit is poured out from on high, the wilderness will become a fruitful field and righteousness will produce peace.

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| 1 | <i>Behold, a king shall reign in righteousness, and princes shall rule in judgment.</i> | A king shall reign in righteousness, and princes shall rule with justice. |
| 2 | <i>And a man shall be as an hiding place from the wind, and a covert from the tempest; as rivers of water in a dry place, as the shadow of a great rock in a weary land.</i> | Each will be like a shelter from the wind, a refuge from the storm — like streams of water in a dry place, like the shadow of a great rock in a weary land. |
| 3 | <i>And the eyes of them that see shall not be dim, and the ears of them that hear shall hearken.</i> | The eyes of those who see will not be closed, and the ears of those who hear will listen. |
| 4 | <i>The heart also of the rash shall understand knowledge, and the tongue of the stammerers shall be ready to speak plainly.</i> | The heart of the hasty will understand and know, and the tongue of the stammerers will speak readily and clearly. |

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| <p>5 <i>The vile person shall be no more called liberal, and the churl shall be said to be bountiful.</i></p> <p>6 <i>For the vile person will speak villany, and his heart will work iniquity, to practise hypocrisy, and to utter error against the LORD, to make empty the soul of the hungry, and he will cause the drink of the thirsty to fail.</i></p> <p>7 <i>The instruments also of the churl are evil: he deviseth wicked devices to destroy the poor with lying words, even when the needy speaketh right.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But the liberal deviseth liberal things; and by liberal things shall he stand.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Rise up, ye women that are at ease; hear my voice, ye careless daughters; give ear unto my speech.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Many days and years shall ye be troubled, ye careless women: for the vintage shall fail, the gathering shall not come.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Tremble, ye women that are at ease; be troubled, ye careless ones: strip you, and make you bare, and gird sackcloth upon your loins.</i></p> <p>12 <i>They shall lament for the teats, for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vine.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Upon the land of my people shall come up thorns and briers; yea, upon all the houses of joy in the joyous city:</i></p> | <p>The fool will no longer be called noble, nor the scoundrel said to be honorable.</p> <p>For the fool speaks foolishness, and his heart is set on doing evil — to practice ungodliness, to speak error against the LORD, to leave the hungry unfed and to deprive the thirsty of drink.</p> <p>The scoundrel's methods are wicked. He devises evil schemes to ruin the poor with false words, even when the plea of the needy is just.</p> <p>But the noble plans noble things; He stands firm in His noble purposes.</p> <p>Rise up, You women who are at ease; hear my voice. You complacent daughters, listen to my words.</p> <p>In little more than a year You will tremble, You complacent women, for the grape harvest shall fail; the harvest shall not come.</p> <p>Shudder, You women who are at ease! Tremble, You complacent ones! Strip yourselves bare and put sackcloth around Your waist.</p> <p>Beat Your breasts for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vine,</p> <p>for the ground of my people growing up thorns and briers — yes, for all the joyful houses in the exultant city.</p> |
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| <p>14 <i>Because the palaces shall be forsaken; the multitude of the city shall be left; the forts and towers shall be for dens for ever, a joy of wild asses, a pasture of flocks;</i></p> <p>15 <i>Until the spirit be poured upon us from on high, and the wilderness be a fruitful field, and the fruitful field be counted for a forest.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Then judgment shall dwell in the wilderness, and righteousness remain in the fruitful field.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the work of righteousness shall be peace; and the effect of righteousness quietness and assurance for ever.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And my people shall dwell in a peaceable habitation, and in sure dwellings, and in quiet resting places;</i></p> <p>19 <i>When it shall hail, coming down on the forest; and the city shall be low in a low place.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Blessed are ye that sow beside all waters, that send forth thither the feet of the ox and the ass.</i></p> | <p>For the palace is forsaken; the noisy city is deserted. The hill and the watchtower have become dens forever — a delight of wild donkeys, a pasture for flocks —</p> <p>until the Spirit is poured on us from on high, and the wilderness becomes a fruitful field, and the fruitful field is regarded as a forest.</p> <p>Then justice will dwell in the wilderness, and righteousness abide in the fruitful field.</p> <p>The work of righteousness shall be peace; the effect of righteousness, quietness and confidence forever.</p> <p>My people shall live in a peaceful settlement, in safe homes, in quiet resting places.</p> <p>Even when the forest falls down and the city is utterly laid low,</p> <p>blessed are You who sow beside all waters, who let the feet of the ox and donkey range freely.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 9:6-7

v2 — Isa 25:4

v3 — Isa 29:18; Isa 35:5-6; Acts 26:18; 2 Cor 4:6

v6 — Matt 15:19

v7 — Jer 5:26-28

v9 — Isa 28:23; Matt 13:9; Isa 3:16

v15 — Isa 29:17; Ezek 39:29; Isa 44:3; Titus 3:5-6; Luke 24:49

v17 — Isa 26:3; Ps 119:165; Rom 14:17; Phil 4:6-9; Jas 3:17-18

v18 — Zech 2:5; Hos 2:18-23; Jer 33:16; Ezek 34:25-26; Isa 33:20-22

v19 — Isa 28:17

v20 — Eccl 11:1; Isa 30:23-24

Chapter 33

The LORD pronounces woe to the destroyer who was not destroyed and the treacherous dealer. Isaiah calls on the LORD to be gracious, for He is the stability of Zion's times. The LORD will be the judge, lawgiver, and king who saves His people. Zion will see Jerusalem as a quiet habitation, and the inhabitants will not say they are sick, for the people who dwell there will be forgiven their iniquity.

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| <p>1 <i>Woe to thee that spoilest, and thou wast not spoiled; and dealest treacherously, and they dealt not treacherously with thee! when thou shalt cease to spoil, thou shalt be spoiled; and when thou shalt make an end to deal treacherously, they shall deal treacherously with thee.</i></p> | <p>Woe to You, destroyer, who Yourself have not been destroyed — you traitor, whom no one has betrayed! When you stop destroying, you will be destroyed. When You stop betraying, they will betray You.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>O LORD, be gracious unto us; we have waited for thee: be thou their arm every morning, our salvation also in the time of trouble.</i></p> | <p>O LORD, be gracious to us; we wait for You. Be our arm every morning — our salvation in time of trouble.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>At the noise of the tumult the people fled; at the lifting up of thyself the nations were scattered.</i></p> | <p>At the sound of the tumult, peoples flee; when You rise up, nations scatter.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And your spoil shall be gathered like the gathering of the caterpillar: as the running to and fro of locusts shall he run upon them.</i></p> | <p>Your plunder is gathered as the caterpillar gathers; as locusts leap, men leap on it.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>The LORD is exalted; for he dwelleth on high: he hath filled Zion with judgment and righteousness.</i></p> | <p>The LORD is exalted, for He dwells on high; He has filled Zion with justice and righteousness.</p> |

- 6 *And wisdom and knowledge shall be the stability of thy times, and strength of salvation: the fear of the LORD is his treasure.* He will be the stability of Your times — wealth of salvation, wisdom, and knowledge. The fear of the LORD is His treasure.
- 7 *Behold, their valiant ones shall cry without: the ambassadors of peace shall weep bitterly.* Their brave men cry in the streets; the envoys of peace weep bitterly.
- 8 *The highways lie waste, the wayfaring man ceaseth: he hath broken the covenant, he hath despised the cities, he regardeth no man.* The highways are deserted; the wayfarer ceases. The covenant is broken; the cities are despised; man is not regarded.
- 9 *The earth mourneth and languisheth: Lebanon is ashamed and hewn down: Sharon is like a wilderness; and Bashan and Carmel shake off their fruits.* The land mourns and withers. Lebanon is ashamed and withers. Sharon is like a wilderness, and Bashan and Carmel shake off their fruit.
- 10 *Now will I rise, saith the LORD; now will I be exalted; now will I lift up myself.* "Now I will rise," says the LORD.
"Now I will be exalted; now I will lift Myself up.
- 11 *Ye shall conceive chaff, ye shall bring forth stubble: your breath, as fire, shall devour you.* You conceive chaff; You give birth to stubble. Your breath is a fire that will consume You.
- 12 *And the people shall be as the burnings of lime: as thorns cut up shall they be burned in the fire.* The peoples shall be as if burned to lime — like thorns cut down, they shall be burned in the fire."
- 13 *Hear, ye that are far off, what I have done; and, ye that are near, acknowledge my might.* Hear, You who are far off, what I have done; and you who are near, acknowledge My might.
- 14 *The sinners in Zion are afraid; fearfulness hath surprised the hypocrites. Who among us shall dwell with the devouring fire? who among us shall dwell with everlasting burnings?* The sinners in Zion are afraid; trembling has seized the godless:
"Who among us can live with the devouring fire? Who among us can live with everlasting burnings?"

- 15 *He that walketh righteously, and speaketh uprightly; he that despiseth the gain of oppressions, that shaketh his hands from holding of bribes, that stoppeth his ears from hearing of blood, and shutteth his eyes from seeing evil;* He who walks righteously and speaks honestly — who despises the gain of oppressions, who shakes His hands free of bribes, who stops His ears from hearing of bloodshed and shuts His eyes from looking on evil —
- 16 *He shall dwell on high: his place of defence shall be the munitions of rocks: bread shall be given him; his waters shall be sure.* he shall dwell on the heights. His place of defense shall be the fortress of rocks; His bread will be given Him, His water will be sure.
- 17 *Thine eyes shall see the king in his beauty: they shall behold the land that is very far off.* Your eyes shall see the king in his beauty; they shall see a land that stretches far.
- 18 *Thine heart shall meditate terror. Where is the scribe? where is the receiver? where is he that counted the towers?* Your heart shall ponder the terror: "Where is the one who counted? Where is the one who weighed the tribute? Where is the one who counted the towers?"
- 19 *Thou shalt not see a fierce people, a people of a deeper speech than thou canst perceive; of a stammering tongue, that thou canst not understand.* You shall no longer see that fierce people — a people of obscure speech you could not understand, of a stammering tongue you could not comprehend.
- 20 *Look upon Zion, the city of our solemnities: thine eyes shall see Jerusalem a quiet habitation, a tabernacle that shall not be taken down; not one of the stakes thereof shall ever be removed, neither shall any of the cords thereof be broken.* Look on Zion, the city of our appointed feasts! Your eyes shall see Jerusalem, a quiet home, a tent that shall not be moved. Its stakes shall never be pulled up, and none of its cords shall be broken.

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| <p>21 <i>But there the glorious LORD will be unto us a place of broad rivers and streams; wherein shall go no galley with oars, neither shall gallant ship pass thereby.</i></p> <p>22 <i>For the LORD is our judge, the LORD is our lawgiver, the LORD is our king; he will save us.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Thy tacklings are loosed; they could not well strengthen their mast, they could not spread the sail: then is the prey of a great spoil divided; the lame take the prey.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And the inhabitant shall not say, I am sick: the people that dwell therein shall be forgiven their iniquity.</i></p> | <p>But there the glorious LORD will be for us a place of broad rivers and streams where no galley with oars can go, where no mighty ship can pass.</p> <p>For the LORD is our Judge; the LORD is our Lawgiver; the LORD is our King. He will save us.</p> <p>Your tackle hangs loose; it cannot hold the mast firm or spread the sail. Then plunder and spoil in abundance will be divided; even the lame shall take the plunder.</p> <p>No inhabitant shall say, "I am sick." The people who live there will be forgiven their iniquity.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Bashan (BAY-shan) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 7:2
- v2 — 2 Cor 1:3-4; Isa 30:18-19; Isa 59:16; Ps 60:11; Ps 62:8
- v5 — Isa 2:17
- v6 — Ps 112:1-3; Prov 19:23; 1 Tim 4:8; Matt 6:33; Prov 14:27
- v10 — Ps 12:5; Ps 102:13-18
- v11 — Isa 59:4; Ps 7:14; Jas 1:15
- v14 — Heb 12:29; Matt 25:46; Isa 66:24; Deut 5:24-25; Matt 25:41
- v15 — Ps 119:37; 1 John 3:7; Eph 5:11-13
- v16 — Luke 12:29-31; Isa 32:18; Prov 1:33; Isa 49:10; Prov 18:10
- v19 — Isa 28:11; Deut 28:49-50; Jer 5:15
- v22 — Jas 4:12; Acts 5:31; Zeph 3:15-17; Isa 25:9; Ps 89:18
- v24 — Jer 50:20; Rev 21:4; Ex 15:26; 1 John 1:7-9; Isa 58:8

Chapter 34

The LORD summons all nations to hear His fury. His sword will come down on Edom, and the land will become burning pitch. The streams of Edom will be turned to pitch, its dust to

brimstone, and it will not be quenched night or day. The wild beasts of the desert will possess it forever.

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| <p>1 <i>Come near, ye nations, to hear; and hearken, ye people: let the earth hear, and all that is therein; the world, and all things that come forth of it.</i></p> | <p>Draw near, O nations, to hear; listen, O peoples. Let the earth hear, and all that fills it — the world and all that comes from it.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For the indignation of the LORD is upon all nations, and his fury upon all their armies: he hath utterly destroyed them, he hath delivered them to the slaughter.</i></p> | <p>For the LORD is enraged against all the nations and furious against all their armies. He has devoted them to destruction and given them over to slaughter.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Their slain also shall be cast out, and their stink shall come up out of their carcases, and the mountains shall be melted with their blood.</i></p> | <p>Their slain shall be cast out, and the stench of their corpses shall rise. The mountains shall flow with their blood.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And all the host of heaven shall be dissolved, and the heavens shall be rolled together as a scroll: and all their host shall fall down, as the leaf falleth off from the vine, and as a falling fig from the fig tree.</i></p> | <p>All the host of heaven shall rot away, and the skies shall roll up like a scroll. All their host shall fall like leaves falling from the vine — like leaves falling from the fig tree.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For my sword shall be bathed in heaven: behold, it shall come down upon Idumea, and upon the people of my curse, to judgment.</i></p> | <p>For My sword has drunk its fill in the heavens; it shall come down on Edom — on the people I have given over to judgment.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>The sword of the LORD is filled with blood, it is made fat with fatness, and with the blood of lambs and goats, with the fat of the kidneys of rams: for the LORD hath a sacrifice in Bozrah, and a great slaughter in the land of Idumea.</i></p> | <p>The sword of the LORD is bathed in blood; it is gorged with fat — the blood of lambs and goats, the fat of the kidneys of rams. For the LORD has a sacrifice in Bozrah, a great slaughter in the land of Edom.</p> |

- 7 *And the unicorns shall come down with them, and the bullocks with the bulls; and their land shall be soaked with blood, and their dust made fat with fatness.* The unicorns shall come down with them, and the bullocks with the bulls. Their land shall be soaked with blood, and their soil made rich with fat.
- 8 *For it is the day of the LORD's vengeance, and the year of recompences for the controversy of Zion.* For the LORD has a day of vengeance — a year of recompense for the cause of Zion.
- 9 *And the streams thereof shall be turned into pitch, and the dust thereof into brimstone, and the land thereof shall become burning pitch.* Its streams shall be turned into pitch and its soil into sulfur; its land shall become burning pitch.
- 10 *It shall not be quenched night nor day; the smoke thereof shall go up for ever: from generation to generation it shall lie waste; none shall pass through it for ever and ever.* Night and day it shall not be quenched; its smoke shall go up forever. From generation to generation it shall lie waste; none shall pass through it for ever and ever.
- 11 *But the cormorant and the bittern shall possess it; the owl also and the raven shall dwell in it: and he shall stretch out upon it the line of confusion, and the stones of emptiness.* The cormorant and the bittern shall possess it; the owl and the raven shall dwell in it. He shall stretch over it the line of confusion and the stones of emptiness.
- 12 *They shall call the nobles thereof to the kingdom, but none shall be there, and all her princes shall be nothing.* Its nobles shall be nothing; they shall call the kingdom itself nothing. All its princes shall come to nothing.
- 13 *And thorns shall come up in her palaces, nettles and brambles in the fortresses thereof: and it shall be an habitation of dragons, and a court for owls.* Thorns shall grow over its strongholds, nettles and brambles in its fortresses. It shall be a home for dragons and a court for owls.

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| <p>14 <i>The wild beasts of the desert shall also meet with the wild beasts of the island, and the satyr shall cry to his fellow; the screech owl also shall rest there, and find for herself a place of rest.</i></p> <p>15 <i>There shall the great owl make her nest, and lay, and hatch, and gather under her shadow: there shall the vultures also be gathered, every one with her mate.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Seek ye out of the book of the LORD, and read: no one of these shall fail, none shall want her mate: for my mouth it hath commanded, and his spirit it hath gathered them.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And he hath cast the lot for them, and his hand hath divided it unto them by line: they shall possess it for ever, from generation to generation shall they dwell therein.</i></p> | <p>The wild beasts of the desert shall meet with the wild beasts of the island, and the satyr shall cry to His fellow. The screech owl shall rest there and find herself a place of rest.</p> <p>There the great owl shall make her nest and lay and hatch, and gather her young under her shadow. There shall the vultures be gathered, every one with her mate.</p> <p>Seek and read from the book of the LORD: not one of these shall be missing; none shall be without her mate. For the mouth of the LORD has commanded it, and His Spirit has gathered them.</p> <p>He has cast the lot for them; his hand has apportioned it to them with the measuring line. They shall possess it forever; from generation to generation they shall dwell in it.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 10:26; Isa 43:9; Isa 41:1; Isa 1:2
- v3 — Joel 2:20
- v4 — Rev 6:13-14; Matt 24:29; Joel 3:15; Ezek 32:7-8
- v5 — Jer 46:10
- v6 — Isa 63:1
- v8 — Isa 63:4; Isa 61:2
- v10 — Rev 19:3

v11 — Lam 2:8; 2 Kgs 21:13; Zeph 2:14

v13 — Jer 10:22; Jer 9:11

v16 — Ps 33:9; Josh 1:8; Matt 5:18; Isa 30:8; Ps 33:6

v17 — Isa 34:10

Chapter 35

The wilderness and the dry land will be glad, and the desert will blossom as the rose. The eyes of the blind shall be opened and the ears of the deaf unstopped. The lame man shall leap like a deer and the tongue of the dumb shall sing. A highway called the way of holiness will be there, and the ransomed of the LORD shall return to Zion with singing and everlasting joy.

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| 1 | <i>The wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose.</i> | The wilderness and the dry land shall be glad; the desert shall rejoice and blossom like the rose. |
| 2 | <i>It shall blossom abundantly, and rejoice even with joy and singing: the glory of Lebanon shall be given unto it, the excellency of Carmel and Sharon, they shall see the glory of the LORD, and the excellency of our God.</i> | It shall blossom abundantly and rejoice with joy and singing. The glory of Lebanon shall be given to it, the majesty of Carmel and Sharon. They shall see the glory of the LORD, the majesty of our God. |
| 3 | <i>Strengthen ye the weak hands, and confirm the feeble knees.</i> | Strengthen the weak hands and make firm the feeble knees. |
| 4 | <i>Say to them that are of a fearful heart, Be strong, fear not: behold, your God will come with vengeance, even God with a recompence; he will come and save you.</i> | Say to those who are anxious in heart: "Be strong; do not be afraid! Your God will come with vengeance — with divine recompense. He will come and save You." |
| 5 | <i>Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears of the deaf shall be unstopped.</i> | Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears of the deaf unstopped. |
| 6 | <i>Then shall the lame man leap as an hart, and the tongue of the dumb sing: for in the wilderness shall waters break out, and streams in the desert.</i> | Then the lame man shall leap like a deer, and the tongue of the mute shall sing for joy. Waters shall break forth in the wilderness and streams in the desert. |

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| <p>7 <i>And the parched ground shall become a pool, and the thirsty land springs of water: in the habitation of dragons, where each lay, shall be grass with reeds and rushes.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it; but it shall be for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein.</i></p> <p>9 <i>No lion shall be there, nor any ravenous beast shall go up thereon, it shall not be found there; but the redeemed shall walk there:</i></p> <p>10 <i>And the ransomed of the LORD shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads: they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.</i></p> | <p>The burning sand shall become a pool, and the thirsty ground springs of water. In the haunt of jackals — where they lay — shall be grass with reeds and rushes.</p> <p>A highway shall be there, and it shall be called the Way of Holiness. The unclean shall not pass over it. It shall belong to them. The wayfaring man, even if He is a fool, shall not go astray.</p> <p>No lion shall be there, nor shall any ravenous beast come up on it. They shall not be found there. But the redeemed shall walk there.</p> <p>The ransomed of the LORD shall return and come to Zion with singing; everlasting joy shall be on their heads. They shall obtain gladness and joy, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 51:3; Ezek 36:35; Isa 55:12-13; Isa 27:6; Isa 52:9-10
- v2 — Isa 60:13; Isa 25:9; Rom 10:15; Hab 2:14; Amos 9:13-15
- v3 — Heb 12:12; Job 4:3-4; Luke 22:32; Isa 57:14-16; Acts 18:23
- v4 — Jas 5:7-9; Isa 41:10-14; Zeph 3:16-17; Isa 34:8; Hag 2:4
- v5 — Isa 42:6-7; Luke 7:20-23; Isa 29:18; Matt 11:3-5; Isa 32:3-4
- v6 — John 5:8-9; John 7:37-39; Luke 11:14; Isa 32:4
- v7 — Acts 26:18; Isa 49:10; John 4:14
- v8 — Matt 7:13-14; Isa 42:16; John 14:6; Rev 21:27; 1 Pet 1:14-15
- v10 — Isa 30:19; Rev 21:4; Isa 25:8; Isa 51:10-11; Isa 65:19

Chapter 36

In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against the fortified cities of Judah. Rabshakeh stood before the walls of Jerusalem and mocked the God of Israel, urging the people to surrender and not trust in Hezekiah or the LORD.

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| <p>1 <i>Now it came to pass in the fourteenth year of king Hezekiah, that Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the defenced cities of Judah, and took them.</i></p> | <p>In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the fortified cities of Judah and captured them.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the king of Assyria sent Rabshakeh from Lachish to Jerusalem unto king Hezekiah with a great army. And he stood by the conduit of the upper pool in the highway of the fuller's field.</i></p> | <p>The king of Assyria sent the Rabshakeh from Lachish to Jerusalem to King Hezekiah with a large army. He stood by the conduit of the upper pool on the road to the field of the launderer.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then came forth unto him Eliakim, Hilkiyah's son, which was over the house, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, Asaph's son, the recorder.</i></p> | <p>Eliakim the son of Hilkiyah, who was over the household, came out to him along with Shebna the secretary and Joah the son of Asaph, the recorder.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Rabshakeh said unto them, Say ye now to Hezekiah, Thus saith the great king, the king of Assyria, What confidence is this wherein thou trustest?</i></p> | <p>The Rabshakeh said to them, "Say to Hezekiah: 'Thus says the great king, the king of Assyria: What is this confidence in which you trust?'"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>I say, sayest thou, (but they are but vain words) I have counsel and strength for war: now on whom dost thou trust, that thou rebellest against me?</i></p> | <p>You say — but they are empty words — "I have a plan and strength for war." On whom do you now rely, that you have rebelled against me?</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Lo, thou trustest in the staff of this broken reed, on Egypt; whereon if a man lean, it will go into his hand, and pierce it: so is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all that trust in him.</i></p> | <p>You are trusting in Egypt — that broken reed of a staff — which pierces the hand of any man who leans on it. That is what Pharaoh king of Egypt is to all who trust in him.</p> |

- 7 *But if thou say to me, We trust in the LORD our God: is it not he, whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah hath taken away, and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, Ye shall worship before this altar?* But if You say to me, "We trust in the LORD our God," is He not the One whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed, saying to Judah and to Jerusalem, "You shall worship before this altar"?
- 8 *Now therefore give pledges, I pray thee, to my master the king of Assyria, and I will give thee two thousand horses, if thou be able on thy part to set riders upon them.* Come now, make a wager with my master the king of Assyria: I will give you two thousand horses, if you are able to put riders on them.
- 9 *How then wilt thou turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put thy trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?* How then can you repulse even one captain among the least of my master's servants — when you rely on Egypt for chariots and horsemen?
- 10 *And am I now come up without the LORD against this land to destroy it? the LORD said unto me, Go up against this land, and destroy it.* Moreover, have I come up against this land without the LORD? The LORD said to me, "Go up against this land and destroy it." ' ' "
- 11 *Then said Eliakim and Shebna and Joah unto Rabshakeh, Speak, I pray thee, unto thy servants in the Syrian language; for we understand it: and speak not to us in the Jews' language, in the ears of the people that are on the wall.* Then Eliakim, Shebna, and Joah said to the Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, for we understand it. Do not speak to us in the language of Judah in the hearing of the people on the wall."
- 12 *But Rabshakeh said, Hath my master sent me to thy master and to thee to speak these words? hath he not sent me to the men that sit upon the wall, that they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you?* But the Rabshakeh said, "Has my master sent me to speak these words to Your master and to You — and not to the men sitting on the wall, who are doomed with You to eat their own dung and drink their own urine?"

- 13 *Then Rabshakeh stood, and cried with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and said, Hear ye the words of the great king, the king of Assyria:* Then the Rabshakeh stood and called out in a loud voice in the language of Judah: "Hear the words of the great king, the king of Assyria!
- 14 *Thus saith the king, Let not Hezekiah deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you.* Thus says the king: 'Do not let Hezekiah deceive you, for he will not be able to deliver you.
- 15 *Neither let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, The LORD will surely deliver us: this city shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.* Do not let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, "The LORD will surely deliver us. This city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria."
- 16 *Hearken not to Hezekiah: for thus saith the king of Assyria, Make an agreement with me by a present, and come out to me: and eat ye every one of his vine, and every one of his fig tree, and drink ye every one the waters of his own cistern;* Do not listen to Hezekiah.' For thus says the king of Assyria: 'Make peace with me and come out to me. Then each of you will eat from his own vine and his own fig tree and drink from his own cistern,
- 17 *Until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of corn and wine, a land of bread and vineyards.* until I come and take you to a land like your own land — a land of grain and wine, a land of bread and vineyards.
- 18 *Beware lest Hezekiah persuade you, saying, The LORD will deliver us. Hath any of the gods of the nations delivered his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?* Beware lest Hezekiah mislead you by saying, "The LORD will deliver us." Has any of the gods of the nations delivered his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?
- 19 *Where are the gods of Hamath and Arphad? where are the gods of Sepharvaim? and have they delivered Samaria out of my hand?* Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim? Did they deliver Samaria from my hand?

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| <p>20 <i>Who are they among all the gods of these lands, that have delivered their land out of my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?</i></p> <p>21 <i>But they held their peace, and answered him not a word: for the king's commandment was, saying, Answer him not.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Then came Eliakim, the son of Hilkiah, that was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph, the recorder, to Hezekiah with their clothes rent, and told him the words of Rabshakeh.</i></p> | <p>Who among all the gods of these lands have delivered their lands from my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem from my hand?" "</p> <p>But they were silent and answered him not a word, for the king's command was, "Do not answer him."</p> <p>Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, Shebna the secretary, and Joah the son of Asaph, the recorder, came to Hezekiah with their clothes torn and told him the words of the Rabshakeh.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Chr 32:1; 2 Kgs 18:13

v2 — 2 Chr 32:9-23; Isa 7:3

v5 — 2 Kgs 18:7

v6 — Ezek 29:6-7; 2 Kgs 18:21

v10 — 2 Kgs 18:25; Isa 10:5-7

v11 — Ezra 4:7; Dan 2:4

v19 — Isa 10:9-11; Jer 49:23

Chapter 37

Hezekiah tore his clothes and went into the house of the LORD, then sent to Isaiah for a word from God. Isaiah declared that the LORD would put a hook in Sennacherib's nose and turn him back. Hezekiah spread Sennacherib's threatening letter before the LORD and prayed, and that night the angel of the LORD struck down 185,000 Assyrians.

- 1 *And it came to pass, when king Hezekiah heard it, that he rent his clothes, and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the LORD.* When King Hezekiah heard it, he tore his clothes and covered Himself with sackcloth and went into the house of the LORD.
- 2 *And he sent Eliakim, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests covered with sackcloth, unto Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.* He sent Eliakim, who was over the household, and Shebna the secretary, and the senior priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.
- 3 *And they said unto him, Thus saith Hezekiah, This day is a day of trouble, and of rebuke, and of blasphemy: for the children are come to the birth, and there is not strength to bring forth.* They said to him, "Thus says Hezekiah: This day is a day of distress, of rebuke, and of disgrace. Children have come to the point of birth, and there is no strength to bring them forth.
- 4 *It may be the LORD thy God will hear the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master hath sent to reproach the living God, and will reprove the words which the LORD thy God hath heard: wherefore lift up thy prayer for the remnant that is left.* It may be that the LORD Your God will hear the words of the Rabshakeh, whom his master the king of Assyria has sent to mock the living God, and will rebuke the words that the LORD Your God has heard. Therefore lift up Your prayer for the remnant that is left."
- 5 *So the servants of king Hezekiah came to Isaiah.* The servants of King Hezekiah came to Isaiah.
- 6 *And Isaiah said unto them, Thus shall ye say unto your master, Thus saith the LORD, Be not afraid of the words that thou hast heard, wherewith the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me.* Isaiah said to them, "Say to your master: 'Thus says the LORD: Do not be afraid because of the words You have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have mocked Me.

- 7 *Behold, I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.* I will put a spirit in Him, so that He shall hear a rumor and return to His own land. And I will make Him fall by the sword in His own land.' "
- 8 *So Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachish.* The Rabshakeh returned and found the king of Assyria fighting against Libnah, for he had heard that the king had left Lachish.
- 9 *And he heard say concerning Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, He is come forth to make war with thee. And when he heard it, he sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying,* Now the king heard concerning Tirhakah king of Cush, "He has set out to fight against you." When he heard it, he sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying,
- 10 *Thus shall ye speak to Hezekiah king of Judah, saying, Let not thy God, in whom thou trustest, deceive thee, saying, Jerusalem shall not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.* "Say this to Hezekiah king of Judah: 'Do not let your God in whom you trust deceive you by saying that Jerusalem shall not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.
- 11 *Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands by destroying them utterly; and shalt thou be delivered?* You have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands — destroying them utterly. And shall you be delivered?
- 12 *Have the gods of the nations delivered them which my fathers have destroyed, as Gozan, and Haran, and Rezeph, and the children of Eden which were in Telassar?* Did the gods of the nations deliver them — the nations my fathers destroyed — Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the people of Eden who were in Telassar?
- 13 *Where is the king of Hamath, and the king of Arphad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivah?* Where is the king of Hamath, the king of Arpad, the king of the city of Sepharvaim, the king of Hena, and the king of Ivah?" "

- 14 *And Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers, and read it: and Hezekiah went up unto the house of the LORD, and spread it before the LORD.* Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers and read it. Then He went up to the house of the LORD and spread it before the LORD.
- 15 *And Hezekiah prayed unto the LORD, saying,* Hezekiah prayed to the LORD, saying:
- 16 *O LORD of hosts, God of Israel, that dwellest between the cherubims, thou art the God, even thou alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth: thou hast made heaven and earth.* "O LORD of hosts, God of Israel, who is enthroned above the cherubim — You alone are the God of all the kingdoms of the earth. You have made heaven and earth.
- 17 *Incline thine ear, O LORD, and hear; open thine eyes, O LORD, and see: and hear all the words of Sennacherib, which hath sent to reproach the living God.* Incline Your ear, O LORD, and hear. Open Your eyes, O LORD, and see. Hear all the words of Sennacherib, who has sent to mock the living God.
- 18 *Of a truth, LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste all the nations, and their countries,* Truly, O LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste all the nations and their lands,
- 19 *And have cast their gods into the fire: for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone: therefore they have destroyed them.* and have cast their gods into the fire — for they were not gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone. Therefore they were destroyed.
- 20 *Now therefore, O LORD our God, save us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD, even thou only.* So now, O LORD our God, save us from His hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that You alone are the LORD."
- 21 *Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent unto Hezekiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Whereas thou hast prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria:* Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel: Because You have prayed to Me against Sennacherib king of Assyria,

- 22 *This is the word which the LORD hath spoken concerning him; The virgin, the daughter of Zion, hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn; the daughter of Jerusalem hath shaken her head at thee.* this is the word the LORD has spoken concerning Him: "The virgin daughter of Zion despises You and mocks You; the daughter of Jerusalem shakes her head at You.
- 23 *Whom hast thou reproached and blasphemed? and against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thine eyes on high? even against the Holy One of Israel.* Whom have You mocked and blasphemed? Against whom have You raised Your voice and lifted Your eyes on high? Against the Holy One of Israel!
- 24 *By thy servants hast thou reproached the Lord, and hast said, By the multitude of my chariots am I come up to the height of the mountains, to the sides of Lebanon; and I will cut down the tall cedars thereof, and the choice fir trees thereof: and I will enter into the height of his border, and the forest of his Carmel.* By Your servants You have mocked the Lord, and You have said, "With my many chariots I have gone up to the heights of the mountains, to the far reaches of Lebanon. I cut down its tall cedars and its choicest cypress trees. I came to its remotest summit, its densest forest.
- 25 *I have digged, and drunk water; and with the sole of my feet have I dried up all the rivers of the besieged places.* I dug wells and drank water; I dried up with the sole of my foot all the streams of Egypt."
- 26 *Hast thou not heard long ago, how I have done it; and of ancient times, that I have formed it? now have I brought it to pass, that thou shouldest be to lay waste defenced cities into ruinous heaps.* Have You not heard that I determined long ago what I am now bringing to pass? I planned from ancient days that You would crush fortified cities into heaps of ruins.

- 27 *Therefore their inhabitants were of small power, they were dismayed and confounded: they were as the grass of the field, and as the green herb, as the grass on the housetops, and as corn blasted before it be grown up.* Their inhabitants had little power; they were dismayed and ashamed. They were like plants of the field, like tender green shoots, like grass on the housetops — blighted before it grows up.
- 28 *But I know thy abode, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy rage against me.* I know Your sitting down, Your going out and Your coming in, and Your raging against Me.
- 29 *Because thy rage against me, and thy tumult, is come up into mine ears, therefore will I put my hook in thy nose, and my bridle in thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest.* Because Your raging against Me and Your arrogance have come to My ears, I will put My hook in Your nose and My bit in Your mouth, and I will turn You back on the way by which You came.'
- 30 *And this shall be a sign unto thee, Ye shall eat this year such as groweth of itself; and the second year that which springeth of the same: and in the third year sow ye, and reap, and plant vineyards, and eat the fruit thereof.* "And this shall be the sign for You: this year eat what grows of itself, in the second year what springs from that, and in the third year sow and reap and plant vineyards and eat their fruit.
- 31 *And the remnant that is escaped of the house of Judah shall again take root downward, and bear fruit upward:* The surviving remnant of the house of Judah shall again take root downward and bear fruit upward.
- 32 *For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and they that escape out of mount Zion: the zeal of the LORD of hosts shall do this.* For out of Jerusalem shall go a remnant, and out of Mount Zion a band of survivors. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will accomplish this.
- 33 *Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shields, nor cast a bank against it.* Therefore thus says the LORD concerning the king of Assyria: He shall not come into this city or shoot an arrow there. He shall not come before it with a shield or cast up a siege ramp against it.

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| <p>34 <i>By the way that he came, by the same shall he return, and shall not come into this city, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>35 <i>For I will defend this city to save it for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.</i></p> <p>36 <i>Then the angel of the LORD went forth, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians a hundred and fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.</i></p> <p>37 <i>So Sennacherib king of Assyria departed, and went and returned, and dwelt at Nineveh.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And it came to pass, as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, that Adrammelech and Sharezer his sons smote him with the sword; and they escaped into the land of Armenia: and Esarhaddon his son reigned in his stead.</i></p> | <p>By the way that He came, by the same He shall return. He shall not come into this city, says the LORD.</p> <p>For I will defend this city to save it — for My own sake and for the sake of My servant David."</p> <p>The angel of the LORD went out and struck down 185,000 in the camp of the Assyrians. When people arose early in the morning, there were all the dead bodies.</p> <p>So Sennacherib king of Assyria left and returned home and lived at Nineveh.</p> <p>As He was worshiping in the house of Nisroch His god, His sons Adrammelech and Sharezer struck Him down with the sword and escaped into the land of Ararat. Esarhaddon His son reigned in His place.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Nineveh (*NIN-eh-veh*) — The capital of Assyria — the great city to which Jonah was sent; when he preached, the whole city repented; it was later destroyed as Nahum prophesied.

Cross-References:

v3 — Isa 66:9; Hos 13:13; Isa 26:17-18; 2 Kgs 19:3; Ps 50:15

v6 — Isa 7:4

v12 — Gen 11:31

v16 — Ps 99:1; Ex 25:22; Ps 86:10

v17 — 2 Chr 6:40; Ps 17:6

v20 — Ps 46:10

v26 — Acts 4:27-28; Acts 2:23; Isa 46:10-11; 1 Pet 2:8; Isa 10:15

v30 — 2 Kgs 19:29

v31 — Isa 27:6; 2 Kgs 19:30-31; Ps 80:9

v35 — Isa 38:6; 2 Kgs 20:6; Isa 31:5; Jer 23:5-6; Eph 1:14

v36 — Isa 10:12; 2 Kgs 19:35; 1 Thess 5:2-3; Isa 10:33-34; 2 Sam 24:16

v38 — Gen 8:4; Jer 51:27

Chapter 38

Hezekiah fell sick to the point of death, and Isaiah told him to set his house in order. Hezekiah prayed and wept, and the LORD added fifteen years to his life and delivered Jerusalem from Assyria. Hezekiah wrote a song of thanksgiving, praising the LORD who cast all his sins behind His back.

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| <p>1 <i>In those days was Hezekiah sick unto death. And Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came unto him, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order: for thou shalt die, and not live.</i></p> | <p>In those days Hezekiah became sick and was near death. Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came to him and said, "Thus says the LORD: Set Your house in order, for You shall die and not recover."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then Hezekiah turned his face toward the wall, and prayed unto the LORD,</i></p> | <p>Then Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD:</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And said, Remember now, O LORD, I beseech thee, how I have walked before thee in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in thy sight. And Hezekiah wept sore.</i></p> | <p>"Please, O LORD, remember how I have walked before You in faithfulness and with a whole heart, and have done what is good in Your sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then came the word of the LORD to Isaiah, saying,</i></p> | <p>Then the word of the LORD came to Isaiah:</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Go, and say to Hezekiah, Thus saith the LORD, the God of David thy father, I have heard thy prayer, I have seen thy tears: behold, I will add unto thy days fifteen years.</i></p> | <p>"Go and say to Hezekiah: Thus says the LORD, the God of David your father: I have heard your prayer; I have seen Your tears. I will add fifteen years to Your life.</p> |

- 6 *And I will deliver thee and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria: and I will defend this city.* I will deliver you and this city from the hand of the king of Assyria and defend this city.
- 7 *And this shall be a sign unto thee from the LORD, that the LORD will do this thing that he hath spoken;* This is the sign to You from the LORD that the LORD will do this thing that He has spoken:
- 8 *Behold, I will bring again the shadow of the degrees, which is gone down in the sun dial of Ahaz, ten degrees backward. So the sun returned ten degrees, by which degrees it was gone down.* I will make the shadow on the sundial of Ahaz go back ten steps." So the sun turned back ten steps on the dial by which it had gone down.
- 9 *The writing of Hezekiah king of Judah, when he had been sick, and was recovered of his sickness:* A writing of Hezekiah king of Judah, after he had been sick and had recovered from his sickness:
- 10 *I said in the cutting off of my days, I shall go to the gates of the grave: I am deprived of the residue of my years.* I said, "In the middle of my days I must depart. I am consigned to the gates of hell for the rest of my years."
- 11 *I said, I shall not see the LORD, even the LORD, in the land of the living: I shall behold man no more with the inhabitants of the world.* I said, "I shall not see the LORD — the LORD — in the land of the living. I shall look on man no more among the inhabitants of the world."
- 12 *Mine age is departed, and is removed from me as a shepherd's tent: I have cut off like a weaver my life: he will cut me off with pining sickness: from day even to night wilt thou make an end of me.* My dwelling has been pulled up and removed from me like a shepherd's tent. I have rolled up my life like a weaver who cuts me off from the loom; from day to night You bring me to an end.
- 13 *I reckoned till morning, that, as a lion, so will he break all my bones: from day even to night wilt thou make an end of me.* I kept myself calm until morning — but like a lion He breaks all my bones. From day to night You bring me to an end.

- 14 *Like a crane or a swallow, so did I chatter: I did mourn as a dove: mine eyes fail with looking upward: O LORD, I am oppressed; undertake for me.* Like a swallow or a crane I chirp; I moan like a dove. My eyes are weary from looking upward. O LORD, I am in distress; be my pledge of safety!
- 15 *What shall I say? he hath both spoken unto me, and himself hath done it: I shall go softly all my years in the bitterness of my soul.* What shall I say? For He has spoken to me, and He Himself has done it. I walk slowly all my years because of the bitterness of my soul.
- 16 *O Lord, by these things men live, and in all these things is the life of my spirit: so wilt thou recover me, and make me to live.* O Lord, by these things men live, and in all these is the life of my spirit. Restore me to health and make me live!
- 17 *Behold, for peace I had great bitterness: but thou hast in love to my soul delivered it from the pit of corruption: for thou hast cast all my sins behind thy back.* In peace I had great bitterness — but in love You delivered my soul from the pit of destruction. For You have cast all my sins behind Your back.
- 18 *For the grave cannot praise thee, death can not celebrate thee: they that go down into the pit cannot hope for thy truth.* For hell cannot praise You; death cannot celebrate You. Those who go down to the pit cannot hope for Your faithfulness.
- 19 *The living, the living, he shall praise thee, as I do this day: the father to the children shall make known thy truth.* The living — the living — he praises You, as I do this day. The father tells the children about Your faithfulness.
- 20 *The LORD was ready to save me: therefore we will sing my songs to the stringed instruments all the days of our life in the house of the LORD.* The LORD will save me, and we will sing my songs on stringed instruments all the days of our life in the house of the LORD.
- 21 *For Isaiah had said, Let them take a lump of figs, and lay it for a plaister upon the boil, and he shall recover.* Now Isaiah had said, "Let them take a cake of figs and apply it as a poultice to the boil, and He shall recover."

- 22 *Hezekiah also had said, What is the sign that I shall go up to the house of the LORD?* Hezekiah also had said, "What is the sign that I shall go up to the house of the LORD?"

Words in this chapter:

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Isa 38:1-8; 2 Chr 32:24; 2 Kgs 20:1-11; 2 Sam 17:23; Jonah 3:10
v3 — Heb 5:7; Heb 6:10; Ps 18:20-27; Neh 13:14; 2 Chr 31:20-21
v5 — 1 John 5:14-15; Ps 34:5-6; Rev 7:17; Luke 1:13; Ps 147:3
v6 — Isa 37:35
v7 — Judg 6:37-39; Isa 37:30
v8 — 2 Kgs 20:9-11
v10 — 2 Cor 1:9; Ps 102:24
v14 — Isa 59:11; Ps 69:3; Ezek 7:16; Ps 123:1-4; Nah 2:7
v15 — 1 Kgs 21:27; Job 7:11
v17 — Isa 43:25; Mic 7:18-19; Jonah 2:6; Ps 30:3; Jer 31:34
v18 — Eccl 9:10; Ps 30:9; Ps 6:5; Ps 115:17-18; Ps 88:10-11
v19 — Deut 6:7; Ps 119:175; Deut 4:9; Ps 78:3-6

Chapter 39

Hezekiah showed the envoys of Merodachbaladan of Babylon all his treasure house, his armory, and everything in his storehouses. Isaiah rebuked him and prophesied that everything in the palace would one day be carried to Babylon, and his own descendants would serve as eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.

- 1 *At that time Merodachbaladan, the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present to Hezekiah: for he had heard that he had been sick, and was recovered.* At that time Merodach-baladan the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent envoys with letters and a gift to Hezekiah, for he heard that he had been sick and had recovered.
- 2 *And Hezekiah was glad of them, and shewed them the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.* Hezekiah welcomed them gladly and showed them his treasure house — the silver, the gold, the spices, the precious oil, his whole armory, and all that was found in his treasuries. There was nothing in his house or in all his realm that Hezekiah did not show them.
- 3 *Then came Isaiah the prophet unto king Hezekiah, and said unto him, What said these men? and from whence came they unto thee? And Hezekiah said, They are come from a far country unto me, even from Babylon.* Then Isaiah the prophet came to King Hezekiah and said to him, "What did these men say, and from where did they come to you?" Hezekiah said, "They came to me from a far country — from Babylon."
- 4 *Then said he, What have they seen in thine house? And Hezekiah answered, All that is in mine house have they seen: there is nothing among my treasures that I have not shewed them.* He said, "What have they seen in your house?" Hezekiah answered, "They have seen everything in my house. There is nothing among my treasures that I did not show them."
- 5 *Then said Isaiah to Hezekiah, Hear the word of the LORD of hosts:* Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the word of the LORD of hosts:
- 6 *Behold, the days come, that all that is in thine house, and that which thy fathers have laid up in store until this day, shall be carried to Babylon: nothing shall be left, saith the LORD.* The days are coming when all that is in Your house and all that Your fathers have stored up until this day shall be carried away to Babylon. Nothing shall be left, says the LORD.

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| <p>7 <i>And of thy sons that shall issue from thee, which thou shalt beget, shall they take away; and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Then said Hezekiah to Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken. He said moreover, For there shall be peace and truth in my days.</i></p> | <p>Some of your own sons who will come from you — whom you will father — shall be taken away, and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon."</p> <p>Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "The word of the LORD that you have spoken is good." For He thought, "There will be peace and truth in my days."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Kgs 20:12-19
- v2 — 2 Chr 32:25; 2 Chr 32:31
- v3 — Deut 28:49
- v6 — 2 Kgs 25:13-15; 2 Kgs 24:13; Jer 20:5
- v7 — Dan 1:1-7
- v8 — 2 Chr 32:26; 2 Chr 34:28

Chapter 40

The LORD declares, 'Comfort My people,' and commands a voice to cry in the wilderness to prepare the way of the LORD. All flesh is grass, but the word of God stands forever. He who sits above the circle of the earth gives power to the faint, and those who wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength, mount up with wings as eagles, run and not be weary, walk and not faint.

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| <p>1 <i>Comfort ye, comfort ye my people, saith your God.</i></p> | <p>"Comfort, comfort My people," says Your God.</p> |
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- 2 *Speak ye comfortably to Jerusalem, and cry unto her, that her warfare is accomplished, that her iniquity is pardoned: for she hath received of the LORD's hand double for all her sins.* Speak tenderly to Jerusalem and proclaim to her that her hard service is ended — that her iniquity is pardoned — for she has received from the LORD's hand double for all her sins.
- 3 *The voice of him that crieth in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the LORD, make straight in the desert a highway for our God.* A voice of one crying in the wilderness: "Prepare the way of the LORD; make straight in the desert a highway for our God."
- 4 *Every valley shall be exalted, and every mountain and hill shall be made low: and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough places plain:* Every valley shall be lifted up, and every mountain and hill shall be made low. The crooked shall be made straight, and the rough places plain.
- 5 *And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.* The glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together, for the mouth of the LORD has spoken.
- 6 *The voice said, Cry. And he said, What shall I cry? All flesh is grass, and all the goodliness thereof is as the flower of the field:* A voice says, "Cry!" And He said, "What shall I cry?" All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field.
- 7 *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: because the spirit of the LORD bloweth upon it: surely the people is grass.* The grass withers, the flower fades when the breath of the LORD blows on it. The people are grass.
- 8 *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.* The grass withers, the flower fades, but the word of our God shall stand forever.
- 9 *O Zion, that bringest good tidings, get thee up into the high mountain; O Jerusalem, that bringest good tidings, lift up thy voice with strength; lift it up, be not afraid; say unto the cities of Judah, Behold your God!* Go up on a high mountain, O Zion, bearer of good news. Lift up Your voice with strength, O Jerusalem, bearer of good news. Lift it up; do not be afraid. Say to the cities of Judah, "Here is Your God!"

- 10 *Behold, the Lord GOD will come with strong hand, and his arm shall rule for him: behold, his reward is with him, and his work before him.* The Lord GOD comes with might, and His arm rules for Him. His reward is with Him, and His recompense before Him.
- 11 *He shall feed his flock like a shepherd: he shall gather the lambs with his arm, and carry them in his bosom, and shall gently lead those that are with young.* He tends his flock like a shepherd. He gathers the lambs in His arms and carries them close to His heart. He gently leads those that are with young.
- 12 *Who hath measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, and meted out heaven with the span, and comprehended the dust of the earth in a measure, and weighed the mountains in scales, and the hills in a balance?* Who has measured the waters in the hollow of His hand and marked off the heavens with a span — enclosed the dust of the earth in a measure and weighed the mountains in scales and the hills in a balance?
- 13 *Who hath directed the Spirit of the LORD, or being his counsellor hath taught him?* Who has directed the Spirit of the LORD, or as His counselor has taught Him?
- 14 *With whom took he counsel, and who instructed him, and taught him in the path of judgment, and taught him knowledge, and shewed to him the way of understanding?* Whom did He consult, and who gave Him understanding and taught Him the path of justice? Who taught Him knowledge and showed Him the way of understanding?
- 15 *Behold, the nations are as a drop of a bucket, and are counted as the small dust of the balance: behold, he taketh up the isles as a very little thing.* The nations are like a drop from a bucket and are counted as the dust on the scales. He takes up the coastlands like fine dust.
- 16 *And Lebanon is not sufficient to burn, nor the beasts thereof sufficient for a burnt offering.* Lebanon would not suffice for fuel, nor its animals enough for a burnt offering.
- 17 *All nations before him are as nothing; and they are counted to him less than nothing, and vanity.* All the nations are as nothing before him; they are counted by Him as less than nothing and emptiness.

- 18 *To whom then will ye liken God? or what likeness will ye compare unto him?* To whom then will You compare God? Or what likeness will You compare to Him?
- 19 *The workman melteth a graven image, and the goldsmith spreadeth it over with gold, and casteth silver chains.* A craftsman casts an idol, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold and casts silver chains for it.
- 20 *He that is so impoverished that he hath no oblation chooseth a tree that will not rot; he seeketh unto him a cunning workman to prepare a graven image, that shall not be moved.* He who is too poor for such an offering chooses a tree that will not rot. He seeks out a skilled craftsman to set up an idol that will not totter.
- 21 *Have ye not known? have ye not heard? hath it not been told you from the beginning? have ye not understood from the foundations of the earth?* Have You not known? Have You not heard? Has it not been told You from the beginning? Have You not understood from the foundations of the earth?
- 22 *It is he that sitteth upon the circle of the earth, and the inhabitants thereof are as grasshoppers; that stretcheth out the heavens as a curtain, and spreadeth them out as a tent to dwell in:* It is He who sits above the circle of the earth, and its inhabitants are like grasshoppers. He stretches out the heavens like a curtain and spreads them out like a tent to dwell in.
- 23 *That bringeth the princes to nothing; he maketh the judges of the earth as vanity.* He brings princes to nothing and makes the rulers of the earth as emptiness.
- 24 *Yea, they shall not be planted; yea, they shall not be sown: yea, their stock shall not take root in the earth: and he shall also blow upon them, and they shall wither, and the whirlwind shall take them away as stubble.* Scarcely are they planted, scarcely sown, scarcely has their stem taken root in the earth, when He blows on them and they wither, and the wind carries them off like stubble.
- 25 *To whom then will ye liken me, or shall I be equal? saith the Holy One.* "To whom then will You compare Me — that I should be equal?" says the Holy One.

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| <p>26 <i>Lift up your eyes on high, and behold who hath created these things, that bringeth out their host by number: he calleth them all by names by the greatness of his might, for that he is strong in power; not one faileth.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Why sayest thou, O Jacob, and speakest, O Israel, My way is hid from the LORD, and my judgment is passed over from my God?</i></p> <p>28 <i>Hast thou not known? hast thou not heard, that the everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth, fainteth not, neither is weary? there is no searching of his understanding.</i></p> <p>29 <i>He giveth power to the faint; and to them that have no might he increaseth strength.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Even the youths shall faint and be weary, and the young men shall utterly fall:</i></p> <p>31 <i>But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.</i></p> | <p>Lift up Your eyes on high and see: Who created these? He who brings out their host by number, calling them all by name. Because of the greatness of His might and the strength of His power, not one is missing.</p> <p>Why do You say, O Jacob, and speak, O Israel, "My way is hidden from the LORD, and my just cause is disregarded by my God"?</p> <p>Have You not known? Have You not heard? The LORD is the everlasting God, the Creator of the ends of the earth. He does not faint or grow weary; His understanding is unsearchable.</p> <p>He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of those who have none.</p> <p>Even youths shall faint and grow weary, and young men shall fall exhausted;</p> <p>but those who wait on the LORD shall renew their strength. They shall mount up with wings like eagles. They shall run and not be weary; they shall walk and not faint.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Cor 1:4; Isa 51:12; Isa 51:3; Zeph 3:14-17; 1 Thess 4:18
v3 — Mal 3:1; Mark 1:2-5; John 1:23; Matt 3:1-3; Luke 1:16-17
v4 — Luke 3:5; Ezek 21:26; Luke 18:14; Isa 42:15-16; Isa 45:2

v6 — Ps 103:15-16; 1 Pet 1:24-25; Ps 102:11; Jas 1:10-11; Job 14:2
v8 — Mark 13:31; Matt 24:35; 1 Pet 1:25; Ps 119:89-91; Isa 55:10-11
v10 — Rev 22:12; Isa 62:11; Rev 17:14; Matt 28:18; Isa 49:4
v11 — Rev 7:17; Ps 23:1-6; Mic 5:4; Ezek 34:23; John 10:11-16
v12 — Prov 30:4; Heb 1:10-12; Ps 102:25-26; Job 38:4-11; Isa 48:13
v18 — Isa 46:5; 1 Sam 2:2; Isa 40:25; Ex 15:11; Acts 17:29
v28 — Rom 11:33-34; Ps 147:5; Isa 55:8-9; 1 Tim 1:17; Phil 1:6
v29 — Isa 41:10; Phil 4:13; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Col 1:11; Zech 10:12
v31 — Lam 3:25-26; 2 Cor 4:16; Ps 27:13-14; Ps 103:5; 2 Cor 12:9-10

Chapter 41

The LORD challenges the nations to bring their case before Him and asks who raised up the righteous man from the east. He declares to Israel, 'Fear not, for I am with you; I am your God. I will strengthen you and help you.' He will open rivers on bare heights and make the wilderness a pool of water. The idols of the nations are nothing, and their works are vanity.

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| <p>1 <i>Keep silence before me, O islands; and let the people renew their strength: let them come near; then let them speak: let us come near together to judgment.</i></p> | <p>Be silent before Me, O coastlands; let the peoples renew their strength. Let them approach and speak; let us come together for judgment.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Who raised up the righteous man from the east, called him to his foot, gave the nations before him, and made him rule over kings? he gave them as the dust to his sword, and as driven stubble to his bow.</i></p> | <p>Who stirred up one from the east whom victory meets at every step? He gives up nations before Him, so that He tramples kings underfoot. He makes them like dust with his sword and like wind-blown chaff with his bow.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>He pursued them, and passed safely; even by the way that he had not gone with his feet.</i></p> | <p>He pursues them and passes on safely, by paths His feet have not trodden.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Who hath wrought and done it, calling the generations from the beginning? I the LORD, the first, and with the last; I am he.</i></p> | <p>Who has done and brought this about — calling forth the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD, the first, and with the last — I am He.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>The isles saw it, and feared; the ends of the earth were afraid, drew near, and came.</i></p> | <p>The coastlands see it and are afraid; the ends of the earth tremble. They draw near and come.</p> |

- 6 *They helped every one his neighbour; and every one said to his brother, Be of good courage.* Everyone helps His neighbor and says to His brother, "Be strong!"
- 7 *So the carpenter encouraged the goldsmith, and he that smootheth with the hammer him that smote the anvil, saying, It is ready for the soldering: and he fastened it with nails, that it should not be moved.* The craftsman encourages the goldsmith, and the one who smooths with the hammer encourages the one who strikes the anvil, saying of the soldering, "It is good." Then He fastens it with nails so it cannot be moved.
- 8 *But thou, Israel, art my servant, Jacob whom I have chosen, the seed of Abraham my friend.* But you, Israel, My servant — Jacob, whom I have chosen — you are the seed of Abraham My friend.
- 9 *Thou whom I have taken from the ends of the earth, and called thee from the chief men thereof, and said unto thee, Thou art my servant; I have chosen thee, and not cast thee away.* I took you from the ends of the earth and called you from its farthest corners, saying to you, "You are My servant. I have chosen you and not cast you off."
- 10 *Fear thou not; for I am with thee: be not dismayed; for I am thy God: I will strengthen thee; yea, I will help thee; yea, I will uphold thee with the right hand of my righteousness.* Do not fear, for I am with you. Do not be dismayed, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will help you; I will uphold you with My righteous right hand.
- 11 *Behold, all they that were incensed against thee shall be ashamed and confounded: they shall be as nothing; and they that strive with thee shall perish.* All who rage against you shall be put to shame and be disgraced. Those who fight against you shall be as nothing and shall perish.
- 12 *Thou shalt seek them, and shalt not find them, even them that contended with thee: they that war against thee shall be as nothing, and as a thing of nought.* You shall seek those who strive against you, but shall not find them. Those who war against you shall be as nothing at all.

- 13 *For I the LORD thy God will hold thy right hand, saying unto thee, Fear not; I will help thee.* For I, the LORD Your God, hold Your right hand. It is I who say to You, "Do not fear; I will help You."
- 14 *Fear not, thou worm Jacob, and ye men of Israel; I will help thee, saith the LORD, and thy redeemer, the Holy One of Israel.* Do not fear, You worm Jacob, you few men of Israel! I will help you, says the LORD; Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel.
- 15 *Behold, I will make thee a new sharp threshing instrument having teeth: thou shalt thresh the mountains, and beat them small, and shalt make the hills as chaff.* I will make You a new threshing sledge with many sharp teeth. You shall thresh the mountains and crush them, and make the hills like chaff.
- 16 *Thou shalt fan them, and the wind shall carry them away, and the whirlwind shall scatter them: and thou shalt rejoice in the LORD, and shalt glory in the Holy One of Israel.* You shall winnow them, and the wind shall carry them away — the storm shall scatter them. You shall rejoice in the LORD and glory in the Holy One of Israel.
- 17 *When the poor and needy seek water, and there is none, and their tongue faileth for thirst, I the LORD will hear them, I the God of Israel will not forsake them.* When the poor and needy seek water and there is none — their tongue parched with thirst — I the LORD will answer them. The God of Israel will not forsake them.
- 18 *I will open rivers in high places, and fountains in the midst of the valleys: I will make the wilderness a pool of water, and the dry land springs of water.* I will open rivers in bare heights and fountains in the midst of the valleys. I will make the wilderness a pool of water and the dry land springs of water.
- 19 *I will plant in the wilderness the cedar, the shittah tree, and the myrtle, and the oil tree; I will set in the desert the fir tree, and the pine, and the box tree together:* I will put in the wilderness the cedar, the acacia, the myrtle, and the olive tree. I will place in the desert the cypress, the plane, and the pine together,

- 20 *That they may see, and know, and consider, and understand together, that the hand of the LORD hath done this, and the Holy One of Israel hath created it.* so that they may see and know, may consider and understand together, that the hand of the LORD has done this — the Holy One of Israel has created it.
- 21 *Produce your cause, saith the LORD; bring forth your strong reasons, saith the King of Jacob.* "Present Your case," says the LORD. "Bring forward Your strong arguments," says the King of Jacob.
- 22 *Let them bring them forth, and shew us what shall happen: let them shew the former things, what they be, that we may consider them, and know the latter end of them; or declare us things for to come.* Let them bring and tell us what will happen. Tell us the former things — what they were — so that we may consider them and know their outcome. Or declare to us the things to come.
- 23 *Shew the things that are to come hereafter, that we may know that ye are gods: yea, do good, or do evil, that we may be dismayed, and behold it together.* Tell us what is to come in the future, so we may know that You are gods. Do good, or do harm — that we may be filled with awe and fear.
- 24 *Behold, ye are of nothing, and your work of nought: an abomination is he that chooseth you.* You are less than nothing, and Your deeds are empty. Whoever chooses you is detestable.
- 25 *I have raised up one from the north, and he shall come: from the rising of the sun shall he call upon my name: and he shall come upon princes as upon mortar, and as the potter treadeth clay.* I stirred up one from the north, and He has come — from the rising of the sun He calls on My name. He tramples on rulers like mortar, as the potter treads clay.
- 26 *Who hath declared from the beginning, that we may know? and beforetime, that we may say, He is righteous? yea, there is none that sheweth, yea, there is none that declareth, yea, there is none that heareth your words.* Who declared this from the beginning, so that we could know — or beforehand, that we might say, "He is right"? No one declared it, no one proclaimed it, no one heard your words.

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| <p>27 <i>The first shall say to Zion, Behold, behold them: and I will give to Jerusalem one that bringeth good tidings.</i></p> <p>28 <i>For I beheld, and there was no man; even among them, and there was no counsellor, that, when I asked of them, could answer a word.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Behold, they are all vanity; their works are nothing: their molten images are wind and confusion.</i></p> | <p>I was the first to say to Zion, "Here they are!" and to Jerusalem, "I will give You a herald of good news."</p> <p>But when I look, there is no one — no one among them to give counsel; not one who can answer when I ask.</p> <p>They are all nothing; their works are empty. Their metal images are wind and confusion.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 1:18; Hab 2:20; Zech 2:13; Ps 46:10
- v4 — Rev 22:13; Isa 48:12; Rev 1:17; Isa 44:6-7; Isa 46:10
- v8 — Jas 2:23; 2 Chr 20:7; Ex 19:5-6; Deut 14:2; John 15:14-15
- v9 — 1 Sam 12:22; Ps 94:14; Deut 7:6-7; Jas 2:5; Josh 24:2-4
- v10 — Josh 1:9; Isa 43:1-2; Rom 8:31; Deut 31:6-8; Phil 4:13
- v11 — Ex 23:22; Isa 45:24; Rev 3:9; Acts 16:39; Isa 54:17
- v13 — Isa 41:10; Ps 73:23; Ps 63:8; Ps 109:31; Isa 42:6
- v14 — Isa 54:5; Isa 43:14; Ps 22:6; Jer 50:34; Job 25:6
- v15 — Mic 4:13; 2 Cor 10:4-5; Zech 4:7; Hab 3:12; Isa 21:10
- v17 — Isa 55:1; Isa 30:19; Isa 44:3; Matt 5:6; Isa 61:1
- v18 — Isa 35:6-7; Ps 107:35; Isa 58:11; Isa 30:25; Rev 7:17
- v19 — Isa 55:13; Isa 37:31-32; Isa 35:1; Isa 60:13; Isa 60:21

Chapter 42

The LORD presents His Servant, on whom He has put His Spirit, who will bring justice to the nations. He will not cry out or raise His voice in the streets, and a bruised reed He will not break. The LORD calls this Servant as a covenant for the people and a light to the nations. Israel is blind and deaf though the LORD made them His witnesses.

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| <p>1 <i>Behold my servant, whom I uphold;
mine elect, in whom my soul
delighteth; I have put my spirit upon
him: he shall bring forth judgment to
the Gentiles.</i></p> <p>2 <i>He shall not cry, nor lift up, nor cause
his voice to be heard in the street.</i></p> <p>3 <i>A bruised reed shall he not break, and
the smoking flax shall he not quench:
he shall bring forth judgment in truth.</i></p> <p>4 <i>He shall not fail nor be discouraged,
till he have set judgment in the earth:
and the isles shall wait for his law.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Thus saith God the LORD, he that
created the heavens, and stretched
them out; he that spread forth the
earth, and that which cometh out of it;
he that giveth breath unto the people
upon it, and spirit to them that walk
therein:</i></p> <p>6 <i>I the LORD have called thee in
righteousness, and will hold thine
hand, and will keep thee, and give
thee for a covenant of the people, for
a light of the Gentiles;</i></p> <p>7 <i>To open the blind eyes, to bring out
the prisoners from the prison, and
them that sit in darkness out of the
prison house.</i></p> <p>8 <i>I am the LORD: that is my name: and
my glory will I not give to another,
neither my praise to graven images.</i></p> | <p>Here is My servant, whom I uphold —
My chosen one, in whom My soul
delights. I have put My Spirit on Him;
He shall bring justice to the nations.</p> <p>He shall not cry out or raise His voice;
He shall not make it heard in the street.</p> <p>A bruised reed He shall not break, and
a smoldering wick He shall not
quench. He shall bring forth justice in
truth.</p> <p>He shall not grow faint or be
discouraged until He has established
justice in the earth. The coastlands wait
for His law.</p> <p>Thus says God the LORD — who
created the heavens and stretched them
out, who spread out the earth and what
comes from it, who gives breath to the
people on it and spirit to those who
walk in it:</p> <p>"I am the LORD; I have called You in
righteousness. I will take You by the
hand and keep You. I will give You as
a covenant to the people, as a light to
the nations,
to open the eyes of the blind, to bring
out the prisoners from the dungeon —
from the prison those who sit in
darkness."</p> <p>I am the LORD — that is My name.
My glory I will not give to another, nor
My praise to carved idols.</p> |
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- 9 *Behold, the former things are come to pass, and new things do I declare: before they spring forth I tell you of them.* The former things have come to pass, and new things I now declare. Before they spring forth I tell You of them.
- 10 *Sing unto the LORD a new song, and his praise from the end of the earth, ye that go down to the sea, and all that is therein; the isles, and the inhabitants thereof.* Sing to the LORD a new song, His praise from the end of the earth — you who go down to the sea, and all that fills it, the coastlands and their inhabitants.
- 11 *Let the wilderness and the cities thereof lift up their voice, the villages that Kedar doth inhabit: let the inhabitants of the rock sing, let them shout from the top of the mountains.* Let the wilderness and its towns lift up their voice, the villages that Kedar inhabits. Let the inhabitants of the rocks sing — let them shout from the tops of the mountains.
- 12 *Let them give glory unto the LORD, and declare his praise in the islands.* Let them give glory to the LORD and declare His praise in the coastlands.
- 13 *The LORD shall go forth as a mighty man, he shall stir up jealousy like a man of war: he shall cry, yea, roar; he shall prevail against his enemies.* The LORD goes out like a warrior — like a man of war he stirs up his zeal. He cries out and roars; He prevails against His enemies.
- 14 *I have long time holden my peace; I have been still, and refrained myself: now will I cry like a travailing woman; I will destroy and devour at once.* For a long time I have been silent; I have held Myself back and restrained Myself. Now I will cry out like a woman in labor — I will gasp and pant.
- 15 *I will make waste mountains and hills, and dry up all their herbs; and I will make the rivers islands, and I will dry up the pools.* I will lay waste mountains and hills and dry up all their vegetation. I will turn rivers into dry land and dry up the pools.

- 16 *And I will bring the blind by a way that they knew not; I will lead them in paths that they have not known: I will make darkness light before them, and crooked things straight. These things will I do unto them, and not forsake them.* I will lead the blind in ways they do not know; in paths that they have not known I will guide them. I will turn darkness before them into light and the rough places into level ground. These are the things I will do, and I will not forsake them.
- 17 *They shall be turned back, they shall be greatly ashamed, that trust in graven images, that say to the molten images, Ye are our gods.* They shall be turned back and utterly ashamed — those who trust in carved images, who say to metal idols, "You are our gods."
- 18 *Hear, ye deaf; and look, ye blind, that ye may see.* Hear, You deaf; look, you blind, that you may see!
- 19 *Who is blind, but my servant? or deaf, as my messenger that I sent? who is blind as he that is perfect, and blind as the LORD's servant?* Who is blind but My servant, or deaf like My messenger whom I send? Who is blind like My dedicated one, or blind like the servant of the LORD?
- 20 *Seeing many things, but thou observest not; opening the ears, but he heareth not.* You see many things, but You do not observe them. His ears are open, but He does not hear.
- 21 *The LORD is well pleased for his righteousness' sake; he will magnify the law, and make it honourable.* The LORD was pleased, for His righteousness' sake, to make His law great and glorious.
- 22 *But this is a people robbed and spoiled; they are all of them snared in holes, and they are hid in prison houses: they are for a prey, and none delivereth; for a spoil, and none saith, Restore.* But this is a people plundered and looted; all of them are trapped in holes or hidden in prisons. They have become plunder with no one to rescue, spoil with no one to say, "Restore!"
- 23 *Who among you will give ear to this? who will hearken and hear for the time to come?* Who among You will listen to this? Who will pay attention and hear for the time to come?

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| <p>24 <i>Who gave Jacob for a spoil, and Israel to the robbers? did not the LORD, he against whom we have sinned? for they would not walk in his ways, neither were they obedient unto his law.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Therefore he hath poured upon him the fury of his anger, and the strength of battle: and it hath set him on fire round about, yet he knew not; and it burned him, yet he laid it not to heart.</i></p> | <p>Who gave up Jacob to be plundered, and Israel to the robbers? Was it not the LORD — He against whom we sinned? For they would not walk in His ways and would not obey His law.</p> <p>So He poured on Him the heat of His anger and the violence of war. It set Him on fire all around, but He did not understand. It burned Him, but He did not take it to heart.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 12:18-21; Luke 3:22; Isa 52:13; Isa 61:1; Isa 43:10
- v3 — Ezek 34:16; Jer 31:25; Isa 40:11; Ps 147:3; Matt 11:28
- v4 — Isa 53:2-12; Isa 55:5; Isa 52:13-15; Ps 22:27; Gen 49:10
- v5 — Isa 40:22; Isa 45:12; Jer 10:12; Zech 12:1; Isa 48:13
- v6 — Luke 2:32; John 8:12; Isa 26:3; Acts 13:47; Isa 49:8
- v7 — Eph 1:17-18; Isa 61:1; Isa 35:5; Isa 49:9; 2 Tim 2:26
- v8 — Isa 48:11; Isa 43:11; Ex 34:14; Ex 20:3-5; Ps 83:18
- v9 — Isa 43:19; Isa 46:9-10; John 13:19; 2 Pet 1:19-21; Isa 44:7-8
- v10 — Ps 33:3; Rom 15:9-11; Isa 42:4; Ps 40:3
- v13 — Ex 15:1-3; Ps 78:65; Isa 59:16-19; Amos 1:2; Zeph 3:8
- v16 — Isa 30:21; Luke 3:5; Isa 35:8; Isa 60:19-20; Isa 40:4
- v22 — Ps 102:20; Jer 50:17; Isa 51:23; Isa 24:22; Ps 50:22

Chapter 43

The LORD declares, 'Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine.' When Israel passes through the waters, the LORD will be with them. He blots out their transgressions for His own sake and will not remember their sins. He is doing a new thing -- making a way in the wilderness and rivers in the desert.

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| <p>1 <i>But now thus saith the LORD that created thee, O Jacob, and he that formed thee, O Israel, Fear not: for I have redeemed thee, I have called thee by thy name; thou art mine.</i></p> <p>2 <i>When thou passest through the waters, I will be with thee; and through the rivers, they shall not overflow thee: when thou walkest through the fire, thou shalt not be burned; neither shall the flame kindle upon thee.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For I am the LORD thy God, the Holy One of Israel, thy Saviour: I gave Egypt for thy ransom, Ethiopia and Seba for thee.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Since thou wast precious in my sight, thou hast been honourable, and I have loved thee: therefore will I give men for thee, and people for thy life.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Fear not: for I am with thee: I will bring thy seed from the east, and gather thee from the west;</i></p> <p>6 <i>I will say to the north, Give up; and to the south, Keep not back: bring my sons from far, and my daughters from the ends of the earth;</i></p> <p>7 <i>Even every one that is called by my name: for I have created him for my glory, I have formed him; yea, I have made him.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Bring forth the blind people that have eyes, and the deaf that have ears.</i></p> | <p>But now thus says the LORD — He who created you, O Jacob, he who formed you, O Israel: "Do not fear, for I have redeemed you. I have called you by name; you are Mine.</p> <p>When You pass through the waters, I will be with You. When You pass through the rivers, they shall not sweep over You. When You walk through the fire, You shall not be burned — the flame shall not consume You.</p> <p>For I am the LORD Your God, the Holy One of Israel, Your Savior. I give Egypt as Your ransom — Cush and Seba in exchange for You.</p> <p>Because You are precious in My eyes and honored, and I love You, I give men in return for You and peoples in exchange for Your life.</p> <p>Do not fear, for I am with You. I will bring Your offspring from the east and gather You from the west.</p> <p>I will say to the north, 'Give them up,' and to the south, 'Do not hold them back.' Bring My sons from afar and My daughters from the ends of the earth —</p> <p>everyone who is called by My name, whom I created for My glory — whom I formed and made."</p> <p>Bring out the people who are blind, yet have eyes — who are deaf, yet have ears!</p> |
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- 9 *Let all the nations be gathered together, and let the people be assembled: who among them can declare this, and shew us former things? let them bring forth their witnesses, that they may be justified: or let them hear, and say, It is truth.* All the nations gather together, and the peoples assemble. Who among them can declare this and show us the former things? Let them bring their witnesses to prove themselves right, that they may hear and say, "It is true."
- 10 *Ye are my witnesses, saith the LORD, and my servant whom I have chosen: that ye may know and believe me, and understand that I am he: before me there was no God formed, neither shall there be after me.* "You are My witnesses," declares the LORD, "and My servant whom I have chosen, so that You may know and believe Me and understand that I am He. Before Me no god was formed, nor shall there be any after Me.
- 11 *I, even I, am the LORD; and beside me there is no saviour.* I, even I, am the LORD, and besides Me there is no savior.
- 12 *I have declared, and have saved, and I have shewed, when there was no strange god among you: therefore ye are my witnesses, saith the LORD, that I am God.* I declared, saved, and proclaimed — when there was no foreign god among You. You are My witnesses," declares the LORD, "and I am God.
- 13 *Yea, before the day was I am he; and there is none that can deliver out of my hand: I will work, and who shall let it?* Yes, and from ancient days I am He. There is no one who can deliver from My hand. I act, and who can reverse it?"
- 14 *Thus saith the LORD, your redeemer, the Holy One of Israel; For your sake I have sent to Babylon, and have brought down all their nobles, and the Chaldeans, whose cry is in the ships.* Thus says the LORD, Your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "For Your sake I send to Babylon and bring them all down as fugitives — even the Chaldeans, in the ships that were their boast."
- 15 *I am the LORD, your Holy One, the creator of Israel, your King.* I am the LORD, Your Holy One, the Creator of Israel, Your King.
- 16 *Thus saith the LORD, which maketh a way in the sea, and a path in the mighty waters;* Thus says the LORD — who makes a way in the sea and a path in the mighty waters,

- 17 *Which bringeth forth the chariot and horse, the army and the power; they shall lie down together, they shall not rise: they are extinct, they are quenched as tow.* who brings forth chariot and horse, army and warrior — they lie down together; they cannot rise; they are extinguished, quenched like a wick:
- 18 *Remember ye not the former things, neither consider the things of old.* "Do not remember the former things, nor consider the things of old.
- 19 *Behold, I will do a new thing; now it shall spring forth; shall ye not know it? I will even make a way in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert.* I am about to do a new thing. Now it is springing forth — do You not perceive it? I will make a way in the wilderness and rivers in the desert.
- 20 *The beast of the field shall honour me, the dragons and the owls: because I give waters in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert, to give drink to my people, my chosen.* The beast of the field shall honor Me — the dragons and the owls — for I give water in the wilderness and rivers in the desert, to give drink to My chosen people,
- 21 *This people have I formed for myself; they shall shew forth my praise.* the people whom I formed for Myself that they might declare My praise.
- 22 *But thou hast not called upon me, O Jacob; but thou hast been weary of me, O Israel.* Yet you have not called on Me, O Jacob. You have grown weary of Me, O Israel.
- 23 *Thou hast not brought me the small cattle of thy burnt offerings; neither hast thou honoured me with thy sacrifices. I have not caused thee to serve with an offering, nor wearied thee with incense.* You have not brought Me your burnt offering sheep or honored Me with your sacrifices. I have not burdened you with offerings or wearied you with incense.
- 24 *Thou hast bought me no sweet cane with money, neither hast thou filled me with the fat of thy sacrifices: but thou hast made me to serve with thy sins, thou hast wearied me with thine iniquities.* You have not bought Me sweet cane with money, nor satisfied Me with the fat of your sacrifices. Instead, you have burdened Me with your sins; you have wearied Me with your iniquities.

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| 25 | <i>I, even I, am he that blotteth out thy transgressions for mine own sake, and will not remember thy sins.</i> | I, I am He who blots out your transgressions for My own sake, and I will not remember your sins. |
| 26 | <i>Put me in remembrance: let us plead together: declare thou, that thou mayest be justified.</i> | Remind Me; let us argue together. Set forth your case, that you may be proved right. |
| 27 | <i>Thy first father hath sinned, and thy teachers have transgressed against me.</i> | Your first father sinned, and your mediators transgressed against Me. |
| 28 | <i>Therefore I have profaned the princes of the sanctuary, and have given Jacob to the curse, and Israel to reproaches.</i> | Therefore I profaned the princes of the sanctuary; I gave Jacob over to utter destruction and Israel to mockery. |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 100:3; Isa 43:7; Zech 13:9; Isa 54:4-5; Titus 2:14
- v2 — Isa 41:10; Josh 1:9; Ps 66:12; Ps 23:4; Dan 3:25-27
- v3 — Isa 60:16; Isa 45:15; 2 Chr 14:9-14; Isa 49:26; Ex 20:2
- v4 — Deut 7:6-8; 1 Pet 2:9; Jer 31:3; Rev 3:9; Gen 12:2
- v5 — Deut 30:3; Isa 49:12; Ezek 39:25-29; Luke 13:29; Isa 60:1-11
- v7 — Eph 2:10; Isa 43:21; Eph 1:12; 1 Pet 2:9; Rom 9:23
- v10 — Isa 41:4; Isa 45:6; Isa 46:8-9; Isa 43:12; Isa 44:6-8
- v11 — Hos 13:4; Isa 44:6; Isa 43:3; Isa 45:21-22; Acts 4:12
- v18 — Isa 65:17; 2 Cor 3:10; 1 Chr 16:12; Deut 8:2; Jer 16:14-15
- v19 — Isa 48:6; Isa 42:9; 2 Cor 5:17; Rev 21:5; Isa 41:18
- v21 — 1 Pet 2:9; Heb 13:15; Ps 102:18; 1 Cor 6:19-20; Luke 1:74-75
- v25 — Heb 8:12; Mic 7:18-19; Heb 10:17; Jer 31:34; Isa 1:18

Chapter 44

The LORD declares that He will pour out His Spirit on the descendants of Jacob, and they shall spring up like willows by the watercourses. He is the first and the last, and beside Him there is no God. Isaiah mocks those who make idols from a block of wood -- half they burn for fire and half they worship. The LORD will redeem Jacob and declares Cyrus His shepherd.

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| <p>1 Yet now hear, O Jacob my servant;
and Israel, whom I have chosen:</p> <p>2 Thus saith the LORD that made thee,
and formed thee from the womb,
which will help thee; Fear not, O
Jacob, my servant; and thou, Jesurun,
whom I have chosen.</p> <p>3 For I will pour water upon him that is
thirsty, and floods upon the dry
ground: I will pour my spirit upon thy
seed, and my blessing upon thine
offspring:</p> <p>4 And they shall spring up as among the
grass, as willows by the water
courses.</p> <p>5 One shall say, I am the LORD's; and
another shall call himself by the name
of Jacob; and another shall subscribe
with his hand unto the LORD, and
surname himself by the name of
Israel.</p> <p>6 Thus saith the LORD the King of
Israel, and his redeemer the LORD of
hosts; I am the first, and I am the last;
and beside me there is no God.</p> <p>7 And who, as I, shall call, and shall
declare it, and set it in order for me,
since I appointed the ancient people?
and the things that are coming, and
shall come, let them shew unto them.</p> <p>8 Fear ye not, neither be afraid: have
not I told thee from that time, and
have declared it? ye are even my
witnesses. Is there a God beside me?
yea, there is no God; I know not any.</p> | <p>Yet now hear, O Jacob My servant —
Israel, whom I have chosen!</p> <p>Thus says the LORD Who made You,
who formed You from the womb and
will help You: "Do not fear, O Jacob
My servant — Jeshurun, whom I have
chosen.</p> <p>For I will pour water on the thirsty land
and streams on the dry ground. I will
pour My Spirit on Your offspring and
My blessing on Your descendants.</p> <p>They shall spring up among the grass
like willows by flowing streams.</p> <p>One shall say, 'I am the LORD's';
another shall call Himself by the name
of Jacob; yet another shall write on his
hand, 'The LORD's,' and name Himself
by the name of Israel."</p> <p>Thus says the LORD, the King of
Israel and his Redeemer, the LORD of
hosts: "I am the first and I am the last;
besides Me there is no God.</p> <p>Who is like Me? Let Him proclaim it.
Let Him declare and lay it out before
Me — who has announced from of old
the things to come? Let them tell us
what is yet to be.</p> <p>Do not fear or be afraid. Have I not
told You from of old and declared it?
You are My witnesses! Is there a God
besides Me? There is no Rock; I know
not any."</p> |
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- 9 *They that make a graven image are all of them vanity; and their delectable things shall not profit; and they are their own witnesses; they see not, nor know; that they may be ashamed.* All who make carved idols are nothing, and the things they treasure are worthless. Their witnesses see nothing and know nothing — so they will be put to shame.
- 10 *Who hath formed a god, or molten a graven image that is profitable for nothing?* Who fashions a god or casts an idol that is profitable for nothing?
- 11 *Behold, all his fellows shall be ashamed: and the workmen, they are of men: let them all be gathered together, let them stand up; yet they shall fear, and they shall be ashamed together.* All His companions shall be put to shame; the craftsmen are only human. Let them all assemble and stand. They shall be terrified; they shall be put to shame together.
- 12 *The smith with the tongs both worketh in the coals, and fashioneth it with hammers, and worketh it with the strength of his arms: yea, he is hungry, and his strength faileth: he drinketh no water, and is faint.* The ironsmith takes a tool and works it over the coals. He fashions it with hammers and works it with His strong arm. He grows hungry, and His strength fails. He drinks no water and is faint.
- 13 *The carpenter stretcheth out his rule; he marketh it out with a line; he fitteth it with planes, and he marketh it out with the compass, and maketh it after the figure of a man, according to the beauty of a man; that it may remain in the house.* The carpenter measures with a line and marks it with a pencil. He shapes it with planes and marks it with a compass. He shapes it into the figure of a man, with the beauty of a man, to dwell in a house.
- 14 *He heweth him down cedars, and taketh the cypress and the oak, which he strengtheneth for himself among the trees of the forest: he planteth an ash, and the rain doth nourish it.* He cuts down cedars — or chooses a cypress or an oak — letting it grow strong among the trees of the forest. He plants a cedar and the rain nourishes it.

- 15 *Then shall it be for a man to burn: for he will take thereof, and warm himself; yea, he kindleth it, and baketh bread; yea, he maketh a god, and worshippeth it; he maketh it a graven image, and falleth down thereto.* Then it becomes fuel for a man — he takes part of it and warms himself; he kindles a fire and bakes bread. He also makes a god and worships it; He makes a carved image and bows down to it.
- 16 *He burneth part thereof in the fire; with part thereof he eateth flesh; he roasteth roast, and is satisfied: yea, he warmeth himself, and saith, Aha, I am warm, I have seen the fire:* Half of it He burns in the fire. With that half He roasts meat and is satisfied. He also warms Himself and says, "I am warm; I have seen the fire!"
- 17 *And the residue thereof he maketh a god, even his graven image: he falleth down unto it, and worshippeth it, and prayeth unto it, and saith, Deliver me; for thou art my god.* The other half He makes into a god — His idol. He bows down to it and worships it. He prays to it and says, "Deliver me, for You are my god!"
- 18 *They have not known nor understood: for he hath shut their eyes, that they cannot see; and their hearts, that they cannot understand.* They do not know; they do not understand. Their eyes are closed so they cannot see, and their hearts, so they cannot understand.
- 19 *And none considereth in his heart, neither is there knowledge nor understanding to say, I have burned part of it in the fire; yea, also I have baked bread upon the coals thereof; I have roasted flesh, and eaten it: and shall I make the residue thereof an abomination? shall I fall down to the stock of a tree?* No one reflects, no one has knowledge or understanding to say, "Half of it I burned in the fire. I also baked bread on its coals and roasted meat and ate it. Shall I make the rest of it detestable? Shall I fall down before a block of wood?"
- 20 *He feedeth on ashes: a deceived heart hath turned him aside, that he cannot deliver his soul, nor say, Is there not a lie in my right hand?* He is feeding on ashes; a deluded heart has led Him astray. He cannot deliver Himself or say, "Is there not a lie in my right hand?"

- 21 *Remember these, O Jacob and Israel; for thou art my servant: I have formed thee; thou art my servant: O Israel, thou shalt not be forgotten of me.* Remember these things, O Jacob — and Israel, for you are My servant. I formed you; you are My servant. O Israel, you will not be forgotten by Me.
- 22 *I have blotted out, as a thick cloud, thy transgressions, and, as a cloud, thy sins: return unto me; for I have redeemed thee.* I have swept away your transgressions like a cloud and your sins like a mist. Return to Me, for I have redeemed you.
- 23 *Sing, O ye heavens; for the LORD hath done it: shout, ye lower parts of the earth: break forth into singing, ye mountains, O forest, and every tree therein: for the LORD hath redeemed Jacob, and glorified himself in Israel.* Sing, O heavens, for the LORD has done it! Shout, O depths of the earth! Break forth in singing, O mountains — O forest, and every tree in it! For the LORD has redeemed Jacob and glorified himself in Israel.
- 24 *Thus saith the LORD, thy redeemer, and he that formed thee from the womb, I am the LORD that maketh all things; that stretcheth forth the heavens alone; that spreadeth abroad the earth by myself;* Thus says the LORD, Your Redeemer — who formed You from the womb: "I am the LORD, who made all things, who alone stretched out the heavens, who spread out the earth by Myself,
- 25 *That frustrateth the tokens of the liars, and maketh diviners mad; that turneth wise men backward, and maketh their knowledge foolish;* who foils the omens of boasters and makes diviners look foolish, who turns wise men back and makes their knowledge nonsense,
- 26 *That confirmeth the word of his servant, and performeth the counsel of his messengers; that saith to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be inhabited; and to the cities of Judah, Ye shall be built, and I will raise up the decayed places thereof;* who confirms the word of His servant and fulfills the counsel of his messengers — who says of Jerusalem, 'She shall be inhabited,' and of the cities of Judah, 'They shall be built, and I will raise up their ruins,'
- 27 *That saith to the deep, Be dry, and I will dry up thy rivers:* who says to the deep, 'Be dry; I will dry up Your rivers,'

- 28 *That saith of Cyrus, He is my shepherd, and shall perform all my pleasure: even saying to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be built; and to the temple, Thy foundation shall be laid.* who says of Cyrus, 'He is My shepherd, and he shall carry out all My purpose, saying of Jerusalem, "She shall be built," and of the temple, "Your foundation shall be laid." ' "

Words in this chapter:

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 1:5; Isa 43:1; Isa 46:3-4; Isa 44:24; Isa 43:7
 v3 — Joel 2:28; Acts 2:17; Isa 59:21; John 7:37-39; Prov 1:23
 v4 — Isa 58:11; Ps 1:3; Ps 92:13-15; Ezek 17:5
 v6 — Isa 41:4; Isa 43:10-11; Rev 1:8; Rev 22:13; Isa 44:8
 v8 — Isa 43:10; 1 Sam 2:2; Deut 4:35; Deut 4:39; John 10:30
 v9 — Isa 41:24; Jer 10:14-15; Ps 97:7; Isa 41:29; Hab 2:18-20
 v18 — Isa 6:9-10; 2 Cor 4:3-4; John 12:39-40; 2 Thess 2:9-12; Jer 5:21
 v22 — Isa 43:25; 1 Cor 6:20; Acts 3:18-19; Isa 43:1; 1 Pet 1:18-19
 v24 — Isa 45:12; Isa 42:5; Isa 54:5; Isa 45:18; Isa 44:2
 v25 — Ps 33:10; Job 5:12-14; 2 Sam 15:31; Jer 50:36; Isa 47:12-14
 v26 — Isa 42:9; 1 Kgs 18:36-38; 2 Pet 1:19-21; Acts 2:25-28; Isa 60:10
 v28 — 2 Chr 36:22-Ezra 1:3; Isa 45:1; Ezra 6:3-18; Dan 10:1; Isa 45:13

Chapter 45

The LORD speaks to Cyrus His anointed, whom He has called by name though Cyrus does not know Him. The LORD declares that He forms the light and creates darkness, makes peace and creates evil. He commands the heavens to drop down righteousness and declares that every knee shall bow to Him and every tongue shall swear allegiance.

- 1 *Thus saith the LORD to his anointed, to Cyrus, whose right hand I have holden, to subdue nations before him; and I will loose the loins of kings, to open before him the two leaved gates; and the gates shall not be shut;* Thus says the LORD to His anointed — to Cyrus — whose right hand I have grasped, to subdue nations before Him and strip kings of their armor, to open doors before Him so that gates shall not be shut:

- 2 *I will go before thee, and make the crooked places straight: I will break in pieces the gates of brass, and cut in sunder the bars of iron:* "I will go before You and level the mountains. I will break in pieces the doors of bronze and cut through the bars of iron.
- 3 *And I will give thee the treasures of darkness, and hidden riches of secret places, that thou mayest know that I, the LORD, which call thee by thy name, am the God of Israel.* I will give You the treasures of darkness and the hoards in secret places, that You may know that I am the LORD, the God of Israel, who calls You by Your name.
- 4 *For Jacob my servant's sake, and Israel mine elect, I have even called thee by thy name: I have surnamed thee, though thou hast not known me.* For the sake of Jacob My servant and Israel My chosen, I call you by your name; I give you a title of honor, though you do not know Me.
- 5 *I am the LORD, and there is none else, there is no God beside me: I girded thee, though thou hast not known me:* I am the LORD, and there is no other; besides Me there is no God. I equip You, though You do not know Me,
- 6 *That they may know from the rising of the sun, and from the west, that there is none beside me. I am the LORD, and there is none else.* so that they may know from the rising of the sun and from the west that there is no one besides Me. I am the LORD, and there is no other.
- 7 *I form the light, and create darkness: I make peace, and create evil: I the LORD do all these things.* I form light and create darkness; I make peace and create calamity. I am the LORD Who does all these things.
- 8 *Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness: let the earth open, and let them bring forth salvation, and let righteousness spring up together; I the LORD have created it.* Rain down, O heavens, from above; let the clouds pour down righteousness. Let the earth open and let salvation and righteousness spring up together. I the LORD have created it.

- 9 *Woe unto him that striveth with his Maker! Let the potsherd strive with the potsherds of the earth. Shall the clay say to him that fashioneth it, What makest thou? or thy work, He hath no hands?* Woe to Him who strives with His Maker — a clay pot among earthen vessels! Shall the clay say to the potter, "What are You making?" or "Your work has no handles"?
- 10 *Woe unto him that saith unto his father, What begettest thou? or to the woman, What hast thou brought forth?* Woe to Him who says to His father, "What are You begetting?" or to a woman, "With what are you in labor?"
- 11 *Thus saith the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, and his Maker, Ask me of things to come concerning my sons, and concerning the work of my hands command ye me.* Thus says the LORD, the Holy One of Israel and His Maker: "Will You question Me about things to come, or give Me orders about the work of My hands?"
- 12 *I have made the earth, and created man upon it: I, even my hands, have stretched out the heavens, and all their host have I commanded.* I made the earth and created man on it. It was My hands that stretched out the heavens, and I commanded all their host.
- 13 *I have raised him up in righteousness, and I will direct all his ways: he shall build my city, and he shall let go my captives, not for price nor reward, saith the LORD of hosts.* I have stirred Him up in righteousness, and I will make all His ways level. He shall build My city and set My exiles free — not for price or reward," says the LORD of hosts.
- 14 *Thus saith the LORD, The labour of Egypt, and merchandise of Ethiopia and of the Sabeans, men of stature, shall come over unto thee, and they shall be thine: they shall come after thee; in chains they shall come over, and they shall fall down unto thee, they shall make supplication unto thee, saying, Surely God is in thee; and there is none else, there is no God.* Thus says the LORD: "The wealth of Egypt and the merchandise of Cush and the Sabeans — men of tall stature — shall come over to You and be Yours. They shall follow You; they shall come over in chains and bow down to You. They will plead with You, saying, 'Surely God is in You, and there is no other — no other God.'"

- 15 *Verily thou art a God that hidest thyself, O God of Israel, the Saviour.* Truly, You are a God Who hides Himself, O God of Israel, the Savior.
- 16 *They shall be ashamed, and also confounded, all of them: they shall go to confusion together that are makers of idols.* All of them are put to shame and disgraced; together they go in disgrace — the makers of idols.
- 17 *But Israel shall be saved in the LORD with an everlasting salvation: ye shall not be ashamed nor confounded world without end.* But Israel is saved by the LORD with an everlasting salvation. You shall not be put to shame or disgraced forever and ever.
- 18 *For thus saith the LORD that created the heavens; God himself that formed the earth and made it; he hath established it, he created it not in vain, he formed it to be inhabited: I am the LORD; and there is none else.* For thus says the LORD — who created the heavens, who is God, Who formed the earth and made it, who established it, who did not create it empty but formed it to be inhabited: "I am the LORD, and there is no other.
- 19 *I have not spoken in secret, in a dark place of the earth: I said not unto the seed of Jacob, Seek ye me in vain: I the LORD speak righteousness, I declare things that are right.* I did not speak in secret, in a land of darkness. I did not say to the offspring of Jacob, 'Seek Me in vain.' I the LORD speak the truth; I declare what is right.
- 20 *Assemble yourselves and come; draw near together, ye that are escaped of the nations: they have no knowledge that set up the wood of their graven image, and pray unto a god that cannot save.* Assemble yourselves and come; draw near together, You survivors of the nations! They have no knowledge who carry about their wooden idols and keep on praying to a god that cannot save.
- 21 *Tell ye, and bring them near; yea, let them take counsel together: who hath declared this from ancient time? who hath told it from that time? have not I the LORD? and there is no God else beside me; a just God and a Saviour; there is none beside me.* Declare and present Your case. Let them take counsel together. Who told this long ago? Who declared it of old? Was it not I, the LORD? There is no other God besides Me — a righteous God and a Savior. There is none besides Me.

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| <p>22 <i>Look unto me, and be ye saved, all the ends of the earth: for I am God, and there is none else.</i></p> <p>23 <i>I have sworn by myself, the word is gone out of my mouth in righteousness, and shall not return, That unto me every knee shall bow, every tongue shall swear.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Surely, shall one say, in the LORD have I righteousness and strength: even to him shall men come; and all that are incensed against him shall be ashamed.</i></p> <p>25 <i>In the LORD shall all the seed of Israel be justified, and shall glory.</i></p> | <p>Turn to Me and be saved, all the ends of the earth! For I am God, and there is no other.</p> <p>By Myself I have sworn — from My mouth has gone out in righteousness a word that shall not return: "To Me every knee shall bow, every tongue shall swear allegiance."</p> <p>Only in the LORD, it shall be said of Me, are righteousness and strength. To Him shall come and be ashamed all who were angry with Him.</p> <p>In the LORD all the offspring of Israel shall be justified and shall glory.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cyrus (SY-rus) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 51:20-24; Isa 42:6; Isa 44:28; Ps 73:23; Isa 41:13
- v2 — Isa 40:4; Isa 42:16; Luke 3:5; Ps 107:16; Jer 51:30
- v3 — Isa 48:15; Isa 43:1; Ex 33:17; Ex 33:12; Ezra 1:2
- v5 — Isa 44:8; Isa 44:6; Isa 46:9; Joel 2:27; 1 Kgs 8:60
- v7 — Eccl 7:13-14; Amos 3:6; Ps 75:7; Job 2:10; Isa 31:2
- v8 — Hos 10:12; Isa 61:11; Ps 72:6; 1 Cor 3:6-9; Isa 44:3
- v9 — Rom 9:20-21; Isa 64:8; Isa 10:15; Jer 18:6; Isa 29:16
- v17 — Rom 10:11; Ps 25:3; Isa 54:4; 1 Pet 2:6; Joel 2:26-27
- v18 — Ps 115:16; Jer 10:12; Isa 42:5; Isa 45:12; Gen 1:2
- v19 — Isa 48:16; Amos 5:4; Num 23:19-20; Jer 29:13-14; Prov 30:5
- v22 — John 6:40; Mic 7:7; Heb 12:2; Num 21:8-9; Zech 12:10
- v23 — Phil 2:10; Rom 14:10-12; Isa 55:11; Heb 6:13-18; Deut 6:13

Chapter 46

The LORD contrasts Himself with the gods of Babylon -- Bel bows down and Nebo stoops, carried as burdens on weary beasts. But the LORD has carried Israel from the womb and will carry them to old age. He calls a bird of prey from the east to accomplish His purpose, and His

salvation shall not delay.

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| <p>1 <i>Bel boweth down, Nebo stoopeth, their idols were upon the beasts, and upon the cattle: your carriages were heavy loaden; they are a burden to the weary beast.</i></p> | <p>Bel bows down; Nebo stoops. Their idols are loaded on animals, on beasts of burden. The things You carry are heavy loads — a burden for weary animals.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>They stoop, they bow down together; they could not deliver the burden, but themselves are gone into captivity.</i></p> | <p>They stoop and bow down together. They cannot save the burden; they themselves go into captivity.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Hearken unto me, O house of Jacob, and all the remnant of the house of Israel, which are borne by me from the belly, which are carried from the womb:</i></p> | <p>Listen to Me, O house of Jacob, all the remnant of the house of Israel — you whom I have carried since birth, whom I have held since you came from the womb.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And even to your old age I am he; and even to hoar hairs will I carry you: I have made, and I will bear; even I will carry, and will deliver you.</i></p> | <p>Even to your old age I am He. Even when your hair is gray I will carry you. I have made you, and I will bear you. I will carry you and deliver you.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>To whom will ye liken me, and make me equal, and compare me, that we may be like?</i></p> | <p>To whom will you liken Me and make Me equal? Who can you compare Me to, that we should be alike?</p> |
| <p>6 <i>They lavish gold out of the bag, and weigh silver in the balance, and hire a goldsmith; and he maketh it a god: they fall down, yea, they worship.</i></p> | <p>They pour out gold from a pouch and weigh silver on the scales. They hire a goldsmith, and he makes it into a god. Then they fall down and worship it.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>They bear him upon the shoulder, they carry him, and set him in his place, and he standeth; from his place shall he not remove: yea, one shall cry unto him, yet can he not answer, nor save him out of his trouble.</i></p> | <p>They carry it on their shoulders; they haul it and set it in its place, and there it stands. It cannot move from its spot. If one cries out to it, it does not answer. It cannot save anyone from trouble.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Remember this, and shew yourselves men: bring it again to mind, O ye transgressors.</i></p> | <p>Remember this and stand firm. Take it to heart, you who have turned away.</p> |

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| <p>9 <i>Remember the former things of old: for I am God, and there is none else; I am God, and there is none like me,</i></p> <p>10 <i>Declaring the end from the beginning, and from ancient times the things that are not yet done, saying, My counsel shall stand, and I will do all my pleasure:</i></p> <p>11 <i>Calling a ravenous bird from the east, the man that executeth my counsel from a far country: yea, I have spoken it, I will also bring it to pass; I have purposed it, I will also do it.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Hearken unto me, ye stouthearted, that are far from righteousness:</i></p> <p>13 <i>I bring near my righteousness; it shall not be far off, and my salvation shall not tarry: and I will place salvation in Zion for Israel my glory.</i></p> | <p>Remember the things of old — what happened long ago. I am God, and there is no other. I am God, and there is none like Me.</p> <p>I declare the end from the beginning, and from ancient times things not yet done. I say, "My purpose shall stand, and I will accomplish all My plan."</p> <p>I call a bird of prey from the east — the man of My purpose from a distant land. I have spoken, and I will bring it to pass. I have planned it, and I will do it.</p> <p>Listen to Me, you stubborn of heart, you who are far from righteousness.</p> <p>I bring My righteousness near; it is not far off. My salvation will not be delayed. I will place salvation in Zion, and My glory in Israel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 21:9; Jer 51:44; Jer 50:2

v2 — Jer 48:7

v3 — Deut 1:31; Isa 51:7; Isa 51:1; Ps 71:6; Isa 1:9

v4 — Ps 71:18; Ps 48:14; Ps 92:14; Heb 13:8; Jas 1:17

v5 — Isa 40:18; Isa 40:25; Ps 89:6

v7 — Isa 45:20; Jer 10:5

v9 — Isa 45:21-22; Isa 42:9; Ps 111:4; Isa 46:5; Deut 33:26

v10 — Prov 19:21; Ps 33:11; Eph 1:9-11; Isa 43:13; Prov 21:30

v11 — Num 23:19; Isa 14:24-27; Job 23:13; Isa 41:2; Eph 1:11

v12 — Jer 2:5

v13 — Isa 61:3; Isa 12:2; Isa 62:11; Isa 51:5

Chapter 47

The LORD pronounces judgment on the virgin daughter of Babylon, who will come down from her throne and sit in the dust. She trusted in her wickedness and said, 'No one sees me.' Disaster will come on her suddenly. Her astrologers and stargazers cannot save her from the fire that will consume her.

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| <p>1 <i>Come down, and sit in the dust, O virgin daughter of Babylon, sit on the ground: there is no throne, O daughter of the Chaldeans: for thou shalt no more be called tender and delicate.</i></p> | <p>Come down and sit in the dust, O virgin daughter of Babylon. Sit on the ground, for there is no throne for You — daughter of the Chaldeans. You will no longer be called tender and delicate.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Take the millstones, and grind meal: uncover thy locks, make bare the leg, uncover the thigh, pass over the rivers.</i></p> | <p>Take the millstones and grind flour. Remove Your veil; strip off Your skirt and bare Your leg; wade through the rivers.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Thy nakedness shall be uncovered, yea, thy shame shall be seen: I will take vengeance, and I will not meet thee as a man.</i></p> | <p>Your nakedness will be exposed. Your shame will be seen. I will take vengeance, and I will spare no one.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>As for our redeemer, the LORD of hosts is his name, the Holy One of Israel.</i></p> | <p>Our Redeemer — the LORD of hosts is His name — is the Holy One of Israel.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Sit thou silent, and get thee into darkness, O daughter of the Chaldeans: for thou shalt no more be called, The lady of kingdoms.</i></p> | <p>Sit in silence. Go into darkness, O daughter of the Chaldeans. For you will no longer be called mistress of kingdoms.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>I was wroth with my people, I have polluted mine inheritance, and given them into thine hand: thou didst shew them no mercy; upon the ancient hast thou very heavily laid thy yoke.</i></p> | <p>I was angry with My people. I profaned My inheritance and handed them over to You. But You showed them no mercy. You laid a heavy yoke even on the elderly.</p> |

- 7 *And thou saidst, I shall be a lady for ever: so that thou didst not lay these things to thy heart, neither didst remember the latter end of it.* You said, "I will be queen forever." You did not take these things to heart; You did not think about how it would end.
- 8 *Therefore hear now this, thou that art given to pleasures, that dwellest carelessly, that sayest in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me; I shall not sit as a widow, neither shall I know the loss of children:* So now listen to this, You lover of pleasure, who live so carelessly and say in Your heart, "I am, and there is no one besides me. I will never be a widow; I will never lose my children."
- 9 *But these two things shall come to thee in a moment in one day, the loss of children, and widowhood: they shall come upon thee in their perfection for the multitude of thy sorceries, and for the great abundance of thine enchantments.* Both of these shall come on You in a single day — the loss of children and widowhood. They shall come in full measure, despite Your many sorceries and the great power of Your spells.
- 10 *For thou hast trusted in thy wickedness: thou hast said, None seeth me. Thy wisdom and thy knowledge, it hath perverted thee; and thou hast said in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me.* You felt secure in Your wickedness and said, "No one sees me." Your wisdom and your knowledge led You astray. You said in Your heart, "I am, and there is no one besides me."
- 11 *Therefore shall evil come upon thee; thou shalt not know from whence it riseth: and mischief shall fall upon thee; thou shalt not be able to put it off: and desolation shall come upon thee suddenly, which thou shalt not know.* So disaster shall come upon You, and You will not know how to charm it away. Calamity shall fall on You, and You will not be able to ward it off. Ruin shall come on You suddenly, before You know it.

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| <p>12 <i>Stand now with thine enchantments, and with the multitude of thy sorceries, wherein thou hast laboured from thy youth; if so be thou shalt be able to profit, if so be thou mayest prevail.</i></p> | <p>Keep on with Your spells and Your many sorceries, at which You have labored since Your youth. Perhaps You will succeed; perhaps You will strike fear into enemies.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>Thou art wearied in the multitude of thy counsels. Let now the astrologers, the stargazers, the monthly prognosticators, stand up, and save thee from these things that shall come upon thee.</i></p> | <p>You are worn out with all Your advisers. Let them stand up now — those who gaze at the stars, who study the sky each month and predict what will happen to You. Let them save You from what is coming.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Behold, they shall be as stubble; the fire shall burn them; they shall not deliver themselves from the power of the flame: there shall not be a coal to warm at, nor fire to sit before it.</i></p> | <p>They are like stubble. Fire will burn them up. They cannot save themselves from the power of the flame. This is no fire to warm Yourself at — no coals to sit beside.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>Thus shall they be unto thee with whom thou hast laboured, even thy merchants, from thy youth: they shall wander every one to his quarter; none shall save thee.</i></p> | <p>So too will Your traders be — those You have worked with since Your youth. They will wander off, each going His own way. None of them will save You.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 51:33; Ps 137:8; Jer 46:11; Zech 2:7; Jer 50:42
v3 — Nah 3:5
v6 — 2 Chr 28:9; Zech 1:15; Deut 28:50; Obad 1:10; Jas 2:13
v7 — Deut 32:29
v8 — Zeph 2:15; Isa 32:9
v9 — 1 Thess 5:3; Ps 73:19
v10 — Isa 5:21; Isa 29:15; Rom 1:22; Ps 52:7; Ezek 8:12
v11 — 1 Thess 5:3
v13 — Isa 44:25

v14 — Mal 4:1; Nah 1:10

Chapter 48

The LORD rebukes Israel for swearing by His name without truth or righteousness. He declared former things long ago so they could not credit their idols. For His own name's sake He delays His anger, and He refines Israel in the furnace of affliction. He commands them to go forth from Babylon and declares there is no peace for the wicked.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear ye this, O house of Jacob, which are called by the name of Israel, and are come forth out of the waters of Judah, which swear by the name of the LORD, and make mention of the God of Israel, but not in truth, nor in righteousness.</i></p> | <p>Listen to this, O house of Jacob — you who are called by the name of Israel and came from the line of Judah. You swear by the name of the LORD and call on the God of Israel, but not in truth or in righteousness.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For they call themselves of the holy city, and stay themselves upon the God of Israel; The LORD of hosts is his name.</i></p> | <p>They call themselves citizens of the holy city and lean on the God of Israel — the LORD of hosts is His name.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>I have declared the former things from the beginning; and they went forth out of my mouth, and I shewed them; I did them suddenly, and they came to pass.</i></p> | <p>I declared the former things long ago. They went out from My mouth; I made them known. Then I acted suddenly, and they came to pass.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Because I knew that thou art obstinate, and thy neck is an iron sinew, and thy brow brass;</i></p> | <p>I knew that You are stubborn — your neck is an iron tendon and Your forehead is bronze.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>I have even from the beginning declared it to thee; before it came to pass I shewed it thee: lest thou shouldest say, Mine idol hath done them, and my graven image, and my molten image, hath commanded them.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I told You these things long ago. Before they came to pass I declared them to You, so that You could not say, "My idol did them; my carved image or my cast idol commanded them."</p> |

- 6 *Thou hast heard, see all this; and will not ye declare it? I have shewed thee new things from this time, even hidden things, and thou didst not know them.* You have heard these things; look at all of them! Will You not declare it? From this time on I announce new things to You — hidden things You have not known.
- 7 *They are created now, and not from the beginning; even before the day when thou heardest them not; lest thou shouldest say, Behold, I knew them.* They are created now and not long ago; before today You had not heard of them, so that You could not say, "I already knew them."
- 8 *Yea, thou heardest not; yea, thou knewest not; yea, from that time that thine ear was not opened: for I knew that thou wouldest deal very treacherously, and wast called a transgressor from the womb.* You had not heard; You did not know; Your ear was not opened long ago. For I knew that You would deal very treacherously. You were called a rebel from birth.
- 9 *For my name's sake will I defer mine anger, and for my praise will I refrain for thee, that I cut thee not off.* For My name's sake I hold back My anger; for the sake of My praise I restrain it for You, so that I do not cut You off.
- 10 *Behold, I have refined thee, but not with silver; I have chosen thee in the furnace of affliction.* I have refined You, but not as silver is refined. I have tried You in the furnace of affliction.
- 11 *For mine own sake, even for mine own sake, will I do it: for how should my name be polluted? and I will not give my glory unto another.* For My own sake — for My own sake — I do this. How can My name be dishonored? I will not give My glory to another.
- 12 *Hearken unto me, O Jacob and Israel, my called; I am he; I am the first, I also am the last.* Listen to Me, O Jacob, and Israel, whom I have called. I am he. I am the first, and I am the last.
- 13 *Mine hand also hath laid the foundation of the earth, and my right hand hath spanned the heavens: when I call unto them, they stand up together.* My hand laid the foundation of the earth. My right hand spread out the heavens. When I call to them, they stand up together.

- 14 *All ye, assemble yourselves, and hear; which among them hath declared these things? The LORD hath loved him: he will do his pleasure on Babylon, and his arm shall be on the Chaldeans.* Come together and listen, all of You. Which of the idols declared these things? The LORD loves Him. He will carry out His purpose against Babylon; His arm will be against the Chaldeans.
- 15 *I, even I, have spoken; yea, I have called him: I have brought him, and he shall make his way prosperous.* I, I have spoken. I have called Him, I have brought Him, and His way will succeed.
- 16 *Come ye near unto me, hear ye this; I have not spoken in secret from the beginning; from the time that it was, there am I: and now the Lord GOD, and his Spirit, hath sent me.* Come near to Me; listen to this. From the beginning I have not spoken in secret. From the time it came to be, I was there. And now the Lord GOD has sent Me, along with His Spirit.
- 17 *Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel; I am the LORD thy God which teacheth thee to profit, which leadeth thee by the way that thou shouldest go:* Thus says the LORD, Your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "I am the LORD Your God, who teaches You what is good for You, who leads You in the way You should go.
- 18 *O that thou hadst hearkened to my commandments! then had thy peace been as a river, and thy righteousness as the waves of the sea:* If only You had listened to My commandments! Then Your peace would have been like a river, and Your righteousness like the waves of the sea.
- 19 *Thy seed also had been as the sand, and the offspring of thy bowels like the gravel thereof; his name should not have been cut off nor destroyed from before me.* Your descendants would have been as numerous as the sand, and Your children as countless as its grains. Their name would never be cut off or destroyed from My presence.
- 20 *Go ye forth of Babylon, flee ye from the Chaldeans, with a voice of singing declare ye, tell this, utter it even to the end of the earth; say ye, The LORD hath redeemed his servant Jacob.* Go out from Babylon; flee from the Chaldeans! Declare this with shouts of joy; proclaim it and send it out to the end of the earth. Say, "The LORD has redeemed His servant Jacob!"

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| 21 | <i>And they thirsted not when he led them through the deserts: he caused the waters to flow out of the rock for them: he clave the rock also, and the waters gushed out.</i> | They did not thirst when He led them through the deserts. He made water flow for them from the rock; He split the rock and the waters gushed out. |
| 22 | <i>There is no peace, saith the LORD, unto the wicked.</i> | "There is no peace," says the LORD, "for the wicked." |

Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Isa 42:9; Josh 21:45; Isa 41:22; Isa 44:7-8; Isa 45:21
- v4 — Acts 7:51; Ex 32:9; Zech 7:11-12; Prov 29:1; Rom 2:5
- v10 — 1 Pet 4:12; Prov 17:3; Job 23:10; Heb 12:10-11; Ps 66:10
- v11 — Isa 42:8; Ezek 20:9; Isa 37:35; Ezek 20:14; 1 Sam 12:22
- v12 — Isa 41:4; Rev 1:8; Rev 22:13; Isa 44:6; Rev 17:14
- v13 — Heb 1:10-12; Ps 102:25; Ex 20:11; Isa 45:18; Isa 40:26
- v16 — John 18:20; John 20:21-22; John 3:34; Isa 45:19; Isa 61:1-3
- v17 — Ps 32:8; Ps 25:12; Job 22:21-22; Deut 8:17-18; Isa 30:20
- v18 — Deut 5:29; Isa 66:12; Ps 119:165; Ps 81:13-16; Deut 32:29
- v20 — Jer 50:8; Jer 51:45; Isa 52:9; Rev 18:4; Jer 51:6
- v21 — Isa 43:19-20; Ps 105:41; Isa 41:17-18; Ex 17:6; Ps 78:20
- v22 — Isa 57:21; Job 15:20-24; Luke 19:42; Rom 3:17

Chapter 49

The Servant of the LORD declares that the LORD called Him from the womb and made His mouth like a sharp sword. The LORD says it is too small a thing for the Servant to restore only Israel -- He will also be a light to the nations. Kings shall see and arise, and princes shall worship. Zion says the LORD has forsaken her, but the LORD answers that He has engraved her on the palms of His hands.

- 1 *Listen, O isles, unto me; and hearken, ye people, from far; The LORD hath called me from the womb; from the bowels of my mother hath he made mention of my name.* Listen to Me, O coastlands; pay attention, You peoples from far away. The LORD called Me from the womb; He named Me from my mother's body.
- 2 *And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;* He made My mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of His hand He hid Me. He made Me a polished arrow; in His quiver He concealed Me.
- 3 *And said unto me, Thou art my servant, O Israel, in whom I will be glorified.* He said to Me, "You are My servant, Israel, in whom I will be glorified."
- 4 *Then I said, I have laboured in vain, I have spent my strength for nought, and in vain: yet surely my judgment is with the LORD, and my work with my God.* But I said, "I have labored in vain. I have spent My strength for nothing and emptiness. Yet surely My right is with the LORD, and My reward is with My God."
- 5 *And now, saith the LORD that formed me from the womb to be his servant, to bring Jacob again to him, Though Israel be not gathered, yet shall I be glorious in the eyes of the LORD, and my God shall be my strength.* And now the LORD says — He who formed Me from the womb to be his servant, to bring Jacob back to him and gather Israel to him, for I am honored in the eyes of the LORD, and My God has become My strength —
- 6 *And he said, It is a light thing that thou shouldest be my servant to raise up the tribes of Jacob, and to restore the preserved of Israel: I will also give thee for a light to the Gentiles, that thou mayest be my salvation unto the end of the earth.* He says: "It is too small a thing for you to be My servant, to raise up the tribes of Jacob and to restore the preserved ones of Israel. I will also make you a light for the Gentiles, that My salvation may reach to the end of the earth."

- 7 *Thus saith the LORD, the Redeemer of Israel, and his Holy One, to him whom man despiseth, to him whom the nation abhorreth, to a servant of rulers, Kings shall see and arise, princes also shall worship, because of the LORD that is faithful, and the Holy One of Israel, and he shall choose thee.* Thus says the LORD, the Redeemer of Israel — His Holy One — to One deeply despised, rejected by the nation, the servant of rulers: "Kings shall see and stand up; princes, and they shall bow down, because of the LORD, who is faithful, the Holy One of Israel, who has chosen You."
- 8 *Thus saith the LORD, In an acceptable time have I heard thee, and in a day of salvation have I helped thee: and I will preserve thee, and give thee for a covenant of the people, to establish the earth, to cause to inherit the desolate heritages;* Thus says the LORD: "In a time of favor I have answered You, and in a day of salvation I have helped You. I will keep You and make You a covenant to the people, to restore the land and to apportion the desolate inheritances,
- 9 *That thou mayest say to the prisoners, Go forth; to them that are in darkness, Shew yourselves. They shall feed in the ways, and their pastures shall be in all high places.* saying to the prisoners, 'Come out,' and to those in darkness, 'Come into the light.' They shall feed along the paths, and their pasture shall be on all the bare heights.
- 10 *They shall not hunger nor thirst; neither shall the heat nor sun smite them: for he that hath mercy on them shall lead them, even by the springs of water shall he guide them.* They shall not hunger or thirst; neither scorching heat nor sun shall strike them. For He who has mercy on them will lead them, and by springs of water He will guide them.
- 11 *And I will make all my mountains a way, and my highways shall be exalted.* I will make all My mountains into roads, and My highways shall be raised up.
- 12 *Behold, these shall come from far: and, lo, these from the north and from the west; and these from the land of Sinim.* See, these shall come from far away — from the north and from the west, and these from the land of Sinim.

- 13 *Sing, O heavens; and be joyful, O earth; and break forth into singing, O mountains: for the LORD hath comforted his people, and will have mercy upon his afflicted.* Sing for joy, O heavens; shout, O earth. Break out into song, O mountains! For the LORD has comforted His people and will have mercy on His afflicted.
- 14 *But Zion said, The LORD hath forsaken me, and my Lord hath forgotten me.* But Zion said, "The LORD has forsaken me; my Lord has forgotten me."
- 15 *Can a woman forget her sucking child, that she should not have compassion on the son of her womb? yea, they may forget, yet will I not forget thee.* Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should have no compassion on the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget You.
- 16 *Behold, I have graven thee upon the palms of my hands; thy walls are continually before me.* See, I have engraved You on the palms of My hands. Your walls are always before Me.
- 17 *Thy children shall make haste; thy destroyers and they that made thee waste shall go forth of thee.* Your children hasten back. Those who destroyed You and laid You waste shall depart from You.
- 18 *Lift up thine eyes round about, and behold: all these gather themselves together, and come to thee. As I live, saith the LORD, thou shalt surely clothe thee with them all, as with an ornament, and bind them on thee, as a bride doeth.* Lift up Your eyes and look around — all of them gather and come to You. As I live, declares the LORD, You shall wear them all as an ornament; You shall put them on like a bride.
- 19 *For thy waste and thy desolate places, and the land of thy destruction, shall even now be too narrow by reason of the inhabitants, and they that swallowed thee up shall be far away.* Your waste and desolate places — your ruined land — will surely now be too small for Your inhabitants, while those who swallowed You up are far away.

- 20 *The children which thou shalt have, after thou hast lost the other, shall say again in thine ears, The place is too strait for me: give place to me that I may dwell.* The children born during Your time of bereavement will yet say in Your hearing, "The place is too cramped for me; make room for me to live."
- 21 *Then shalt thou say in thine heart, Who hath begotten me these, seeing I have lost my children, and am desolate, a captive, and removing to and fro? and who hath brought up these? Behold, I was left alone; these, where had they been?* Then You will say in Your heart, "Who bore me these? I had lost my children; I was barren, exiled and put away. Who then raised these? I was left alone — where did these come from?"
- 22 *Thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, I will lift up mine hand to the Gentiles, and set up my standard to the people: and they shall bring thy sons in their arms, and thy daughters shall be carried upon their shoulders.* Thus says the Lord GOD: "I will lift up My hand to the nations and set up My ensign to the peoples. They shall bring Your sons in their arms, and Your daughters shall be carried on their shoulders.
- 23 *And kings shall be thy nursing fathers, and their queens thy nursing mothers: they shall bow down to thee with their face toward the earth, and lick up the dust of thy feet; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD: for they shall not be ashamed that wait for me.* Kings shall be Your foster fathers, and their queens Your nursing mothers. They shall bow down to You with their faces to the ground and lick the dust of Your feet. Then You will know that I am the LORD; those who wait for Me shall not be put to shame."
- 24 *Shall the prey be taken from the mighty, and the lawful captive delivered?* Can the prey be taken from the mighty man, or can the lawful captive be rescued?
- 25 *But thus saith the LORD, Even the captives of the mighty shall be taken away, and the prey of the terrible shall be delivered: for I will contend with him that contendeth with thee, and I will save thy children.* But thus says the LORD: "Even the captives of a mighty man shall be taken away, and the prey of a tyrant shall be rescued. I will contend with those who contend with You, and I will save Your children.

- 26 *And I will feed them that oppress thee with their own flesh; and they shall be drunken with their own blood, as with sweet wine: and all flesh shall know that I the LORD am thy Saviour and thy Redeemer, the mighty One of Jacob.* I will make Your oppressors eat their own flesh, and they shall be drunk with their own blood as with new wine. Then all people will know that I am the LORD Your Savior, Your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob."

Words in this chapter:

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 1:5; Gal 1:15; Isa 44:2; Isa 49:5; Luke 1:31
v2 — Heb 4:12; Rev 1:16; Isa 50:4; Rev 2:12; Isa 51:16
v6 — Acts 13:47; Isa 42:6; Luke 2:32; Ps 98:2-3; Isa 52:10
v7 — 1 Pet 2:4; Matt 26:67; Isa 53:3; Isa 48:17; Ps 22:6-8
v8 — 2 Cor 6:2; Isa 42:6; Ps 69:13; Isa 61:4; Heb 12:24
v10 — Rev 7:16-17; Matt 5:6; Ezek 34:23; Isa 33:16; Ps 121:5-6
v15 — Ps 103:13; Isa 44:21; Matt 7:11; Jer 31:20; Hos 11:1
v16 — Hag 2:23; Isa 62:6; Isa 60:18; Song 8:6; Ex 13:9
v23 — Isa 60:3; Isa 60:14; Isa 60:16; Mic 7:17; Isa 45:14
v24 — Luke 11:21-22; Ps 124:6-7; Matt 12:29; Ezek 37:3; Isa 42:22
v25 — Isa 54:15-17; Isa 35:4; Isa 41:11-12; Jer 50:33-34; Isa 54:13
v26 — Isa 9:20; Isa 41:14-20; Rev 16:6; Isa 9:4; Isa 60:16

Chapter 50

The LORD asks where the certificate of Israel's divorce is and declares that His arm is not shortened that it cannot save. The Servant of the LORD sets His face like flint and gives His back to those who strike Him and His cheeks to those who pluck out the beard. He trusts in the LORD and is not ashamed.

- 1 *Thus saith the LORD, Where is the bill of your mother's divorcement, whom I have put away? or which of my creditors is it to whom I have sold you? Behold, for your iniquities have ye sold yourselves, and for your transgressions is your mother put away.* Thus says the LORD: "Where is the certificate of divorce by which I sent Your mother away? Or to which of My creditors did I sell You? For Your iniquities You were sold, and for Your transgressions Your mother was sent away.
- 2 *Wherefore, when I came, was there no man? when I called, was there none to answer? Is my hand shortened at all, that it cannot redeem? or have I no power to deliver? behold, at my rebuke I dry up the sea, I make the rivers a wilderness: their fish stinketh, because there is no water, and dieth for thirst.* Why, when I came, was there no one? When I called, why did no one answer? Is My hand shortened so that it cannot redeem? Do I have no power to deliver? At My rebuke I dry up the sea; I make rivers a desert. Their fish rot because there is no water; they die of thirst.
- 3 *I clothe the heavens with blackness, and I make sackcloth their covering.* I clothe the heavens with darkness and make sackcloth their covering."
- 4 *The Lord GOD hath given me the tongue of the learned, that I should know how to speak a word in season to him that is weary: he wakeneth morning by morning, he wakeneth mine ear to hear as the learned.* The Lord GOD has given Me the tongue of those who are taught, so that I may know how to sustain the weary with a word. Morning by morning He wakens; He wakens My ear to listen as those who are taught.
- 5 *The Lord GOD hath opened mine ear, and I was not rebellious, neither turned away back.* The Lord GOD has opened My ear, and I was not rebellious; I did not turn away.
- 6 *I gave my back to the smiters, and my cheeks to them that plucked off the hair: I hid not my face from shame and spitting.* I gave My back to those who struck Me and My cheeks to those who pulled out the beard. I did not hide My face from shame and spitting.

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| <p>7 <i>For the Lord GOD will help me; therefore shall I not be confounded: therefore have I set my face like a flint, and I know that I shall not be ashamed.</i></p> <p>8 <i>He is near that justifieth me; who will contend with me? let us stand together: who is mine adversary? let him come near to me.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Behold, the Lord GOD will help me; who is he that shall condemn me? lo, they all shall wax old as a garment; the moth shall eat them up.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Who is among you that feareth the LORD, that obeyeth the voice of his servant, that walketh in darkness, and hath no light? let him trust in the name of the LORD, and stay upon his God.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Behold, all ye that kindle a fire, that compass yourselves about with sparks: walk in the light of your fire, and in the sparks that ye have kindled. This shall ye have of mine hand; ye shall lie down in sorrow.</i></p> | <p>For the Lord GOD will help Me; therefore I will not be put to shame. I have set My face like a flint, and I know I will not be disgraced.</p> <p>He who vindicates Me is near. Who will bring charges against Me? Let us face each other. Who is My accuser? Let Him come near.</p> <p>The Lord GOD will help Me. Who will declare Me guilty? All of them will wear out like a garment; the moth will eat them.</p> <p>Who among You fears the LORD and obeys the voice of His servant? Who walks in darkness and has no light? Let Him trust in the name of the LORD and rely on His God.</p> <p>All You who kindle a fire and equip yourselves with flaming torches — walk in the light of Your fire and among the torches You have set ablaze. This is what You shall receive from My hand: You shall lie down in torment.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

servant (*SUR-vunt*) — the Servant of the LORD; a messianic figure who suffers willingly and trusts God through affliction

Cross-References:

- v1 — Deut 32:30; Jer 3:8; Matt 18:25; Neh 5:5; 2 Kgs 4:1
v2 — Isa 59:1; Num 11:23; Isa 66:4; Josh 3:16; Prov 1:24
v3 — Rev 6:12
v4 — Luke 21:15; Jer 1:9; John 7:15-17; Ex 4:11-12; Prov 25:11

- v5 — John 14:31; Heb 5:8; Phil 2:8; Isa 35:5; John 8:29
 v6 — Matt 26:67; Mark 14:65; Mark 15:19; Matt 27:30; Luke 22:63-64
 v7 — Heb 13:6; Ezek 3:8-9; John 16:33; Isa 42:1; Rom 1:16
 v8 — Rom 8:32-34
 v9 — Job 13:28
 v10 — John 12:46; Isa 26:3-4; Mic 7:7-9; John 8:12; Ps 23:4
 v11 — Jer 17:5-7; Rom 1:21-22; Rom 10:3; Matt 15:6-8; John 8:24

Chapter 51

The LORD calls those who pursue righteousness to look to Abraham and Sarah, from whom He called a nation out of one man. He will comfort Zion and make her wilderness like Eden. Israel is told to awake and put on strength; the cup of the LORD's fury that made them stagger will be taken from their hand and put into the hand of their tormentors.

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| <p>1 <i>Hearken to me, ye that follow after righteousness, ye that seek the LORD: look unto the rock whence ye are hewn, and to the hole of the pit whence ye are digged.</i></p> | <p>Listen to Me, You who pursue righteousness, You who seek the LORD. Look to the rock from which You were cut and to the quarry from which You were dug.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Look unto Abraham your father, and unto Sarah that bare you: for I called him alone, and blessed him, and increased him.</i></p> | <p>Look to Abraham your father and to Sarah who bore you. I called him alone and blessed him and made him many.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For the LORD shall comfort Zion: he will comfort all her waste places; and he will make her wilderness like Eden, and her desert like the garden of the LORD; joy and gladness shall be found therein, thanksgiving, and the voice of melody.</i></p> | <p>For the LORD will comfort Zion; He will comfort all her desolate places. He will make her wilderness like Eden and her desert like the garden of the LORD. Joy and gladness will be found in her — thanksgiving and the sound of singing.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Hearken unto me, my people; and give ear unto me, O my nation: for a law shall proceed from me, and I will make my judgment to rest for a light of the people.</i></p> | <p>Listen to Me, My people; give ear to Me, My nation. A law will go out from Me, and My justice shall be a light to the peoples.</p> |

- 5 *My righteousness is near; my salvation is gone forth, and mine arms shall judge the people; the isles shall wait upon me, and on mine arm shall they trust.* My righteousness is near; My salvation has gone out; My arms will judge the peoples. The coastlands wait for Me, and in My arm they put their hope.
- 6 *Lift up your eyes to the heavens, and look upon the earth beneath: for the heavens shall vanish away like smoke, and the earth shall wax old like a garment, and they that dwell therein shall die in like manner: but my salvation shall be for ever, and my righteousness shall not be abolished.* Lift up Your eyes to the heavens and look at the earth beneath. The heavens shall vanish like smoke; the earth shall wear out like a garment; its inhabitants shall die like gnats. But My salvation will be forever, and My righteousness will never fail.
- 7 *Hearken unto me, ye that know righteousness, the people in whose heart is my law; fear ye not the reproach of men, neither be ye afraid of their revilings.* Listen to Me, You who know righteousness, the people in whose heart is My law. Do not fear the reproach of men; do not be dismayed at their insults.
- 8 *For the moth shall eat them up like a garment, and the worm shall eat them like wool: but my righteousness shall be for ever, and my salvation from generation to generation.* For the moth shall eat them like a garment, and the worm shall eat them like wool. But My righteousness shall be forever, and My salvation to all generations.
- 9 *Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the LORD; awake, as in the ancient days, in the generations of old. Art thou not it that hath cut Rahab, and wounded the dragon?* Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the LORD. Awake as in the days of old, the generations of long ago. Was it not You who cut Rahab in pieces, who pierced the dragon?
- 10 *Art thou not it which hath dried the sea, the waters of the great deep; that hath made the depths of the sea a way for the ransomed to pass over?* Was it not You who dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep — who made the depths of the sea a road for the ransomed to cross over?

- 11 *Therefore the redeemed of the LORD shall return, and come with singing unto Zion; and everlasting joy shall be upon their head: they shall obtain gladness and joy; and sorrow and mourning shall flee away.* So the redeemed of the LORD shall return and come to Zion with singing. Everlasting joy shall be on their heads. They shall obtain gladness and joy, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.
- 12 *I, even I, am he that comforteth you: who art thou, that thou shouldest be afraid of a man that shall die, and of the son of man which shall be made as grass;* I, I am He who comforts you. Why then do you fear a man who is mortal — the son of man who is made like grass?
- 13 *And forgettest the LORD thy maker, that hath stretched forth the heavens, and laid the foundations of the earth; and hast feared continually every day because of the fury of the oppressor, as if he were ready to destroy? and where is the fury of the oppressor?* You have forgotten the LORD Your Maker, who stretched out the heavens and laid the foundations of the earth. You live in constant terror all day long because of the fury of the oppressor who is bent on destruction. But where is the fury of the oppressor now?
- 14 *The captive exile hasteneth that he may be loosed, and that he should not die in the pit, nor that his bread should fail.* The captive who crouches shall quickly be set free. He shall not die in the pit; His food shall not run out.
- 15 *But I am the LORD thy God, that divided the sea, whose waves roared: The LORD of hosts is his name.* For I am the LORD Your God, Who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar. The LORD of hosts is His name.
- 16 *And I have put my words in thy mouth, and I have covered thee in the shadow of mine hand, that I may plant the heavens, and lay the foundations of the earth, and say unto Zion, Thou art my people.* I have put My words in Your mouth and covered You in the shadow of My hand — stretching out the heavens and laying the foundations of the earth, and saying to Zion, "You are My people."

- 17 *Awake, awake, stand up, O Jerusalem, which hast drunk at the hand of the LORD the cup of his fury; thou hast drunken the dregs of the cup of trembling, and wrung them out.* Wake up, wake up! Rise up, O Jerusalem — you who have drunk from the hand of the LORD the cup of His wrath. You have drunk to the dregs the cup that makes men stagger.
- 18 *There is none to guide her among all the sons whom she hath brought forth; neither is there any that taketh her by the hand of all the sons that she hath brought up.* There is no one to guide her — none of all the children she has borne. There is no one to take her by the hand — none of all the children she has raised.
- 19 *These two things are come unto thee; who shall be sorry for thee? desolation, and destruction, and the famine, and the sword: by whom shall I comfort thee?* These two things have come on You — who will grieve with You? — devastation and destruction, famine and sword. By whom shall I comfort You?
- 20 *Thy sons have fainted, they lie at the head of all the streets, as a wild bull in a net: they are full of the fury of the LORD, the rebuke of thy God.* Your sons have fainted; they lie at the head of every street like an antelope caught in a net. They are full of the wrath of the LORD, the rebuke of Your God.
- 21 *Therefore hear now this, thou afflicted, and drunken, but not with wine:* So listen to this, You afflicted one, drunk — but not with wine.
- 22 *Thus saith thy Lord the LORD, and thy God that pleadeth the cause of his people, Behold, I have taken out of thine hand the cup of trembling, even the dregs of the cup of my fury; thou shalt no more drink it again:* Thus says Your Lord, the LORD — your God Who defends His people: "I am taking from Your hand the cup that made You stagger, the dregs of My cup of wrath. You shall never drink it again.
- 23 *But I will put it into the hand of them that afflict thee; which have said to thy soul, Bow down, that we may go over: and thou hast laid thy body as the ground, and as the street, to them that went over.* I will put it into the hand of Your tormentors, who said to You, 'Bow down so we can walk over You.' You made Your back like the ground and like a street for them to walk on."

Words in this chapter:

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 51:7; Ps 94:15; Ps 105:3-4; Heb 12:14; Rom 14:19
- v2 — Ezek 33:24; Gal 3:9-14; Rom 4:1-5; Heb 11:8-12; Gen 24:1
- v5 — Rom 10:17-18; Isa 46:13; Isa 60:9; Isa 42:4; Rom 10:6-10
- v6 — Matt 24:35; Ps 102:25-26; Isa 34:4; Heb 1:10-12; Rev 6:12-14
- v7 — Matt 5:11; Ezek 2:6; Ps 37:31; 1 Pet 4:14; Acts 5:41
- v9 — Ps 74:13-14; Ps 89:10; Isa 52:1; Isa 27:1; Isa 30:7
- v11 — Isa 25:8; Rev 21:4; Rev 7:17; Isa 35:10; 2 Thess 2:16
- v12 — Ps 118:6; Isa 2:22; 1 Pet 1:24; John 14:26-27; 2 Cor 1:3-5
- v14 — Isa 48:20; Zech 9:11; Isa 52:2; Acts 12:7-8; Isa 49:10
- v16 — Isa 59:21; Isa 49:2; John 17:8; Deut 18:18; Jer 31:33
- v17 — Isa 52:1; Rev 14:10; Job 21:20; Isa 51:9; 1 Cor 15:34
- v22 — Prov 22:23; Isa 51:17; Jer 50:34; Isa 62:8; Isa 49:25

Chapter 52

The LORD commands Zion to awake and put on her beautiful garments, for the uncircumcised and unclean shall no longer come into her. How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of him who brings good tidings of peace. The LORD's Servant shall be exalted and extolled, yet His appearance was marred more than any man, and He shall sprinkle many nations.

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| 1 | <i>Awake, awake; put on thy strength, O Zion; put on thy beautiful garments, O Jerusalem, the holy city: for henceforth there shall no more come into thee the uncircumcised and the unclean.</i> | Wake up, wake up! Put on Your strength, O Zion. Put on Your beautiful clothes, O Jerusalem, the holy city. The uncircumcised and the unclean shall enter you no more. |
| 2 | <i>Shake thyself from the dust; arise, and sit down, O Jerusalem: loose thyself from the bands of thy neck, O captive daughter of Zion.</i> | Shake Yourself free from the dust; arise and take Your seat, O Jerusalem. Loose the bonds from your neck, O captive daughter of Zion. |
| 3 | <i>For thus saith the LORD, Ye have sold yourselves for nought; and ye shall be redeemed without money.</i> | For thus says the LORD: "You were sold for nothing, and You shall be redeemed without money." |

- 4 *For thus saith the Lord GOD, My people went down aforetime into Egypt to sojourn there; and the Assyrian oppressed them without cause.* For thus says the Lord GOD: "My people went down to Egypt at the start to stay there, and the Assyrian oppressed them for nothing.
- 5 *Now therefore, what have I here, saith the LORD, that my people is taken away for nought? they that rule over them make them to howl, saith the LORD; and my name continually every day is blasphemed.* Now what do I have here?" declares the LORD. "My people are taken away for nothing. Those who rule over them wail," declares the LORD, "and My name is continually despised all day long.
- 6 *Therefore my people shall know my name: therefore they shall know in that day that I am he that doth speak: behold, it is I.* Therefore My people shall know My name. In that day they shall know that it is I who speak; here I am."
- 7 *How beautiful upon the mountains are the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace; that bringeth good tidings of good, that publisheth salvation; that saith unto Zion, Thy God reigneth!* How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of Him who brings good news — who announces peace, who brings good news of good things, who announces salvation, who says to Zion, "Your God reigns!"
- 8 *Thy watchmen shall lift up the voice; with the voice together shall they sing: for they shall see eye to eye, when the LORD shall bring again Zion.* Your watchmen lift up their voices; together they sing for joy. For eye to eye they shall see the LORD returning to Zion.
- 9 *Break forth into joy, sing together, ye waste places of Jerusalem: for the LORD hath comforted his people, he hath redeemed Jerusalem.* Break forth together into singing, You waste places of Jerusalem! For the LORD has comforted His people; He has redeemed Jerusalem.
- 10 *The LORD hath made bare his holy arm in the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.* The LORD has bared His holy arm in the sight of all the nations. All the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.

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| <p>11 <i>Depart ye, depart ye, go ye out from thence, touch no unclean thing; go ye out of the midst of her; be ye clean, that bear the vessels of the LORD.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For ye shall not go out with haste, nor go by flight: for the LORD will go before you; and the God of Israel will be your rereward.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Behold, my servant shall deal prudently, he shall be exalted and extolled, and be very high.</i></p> <p>14 <i>As many were astonished at thee; his visage was so marred more than any man, and his form more than the sons of men:</i></p> <p>15 <i>So shall he sprinkle many nations; the kings shall shut their mouths at him: for that which had not been told them shall they see; and that which they had not heard shall they consider.</i></p> | <p>Depart, depart, go out from there! Touch nothing unclean. Go out from the middle of her; purify yourselves, You who carry the vessels of the LORD.</p> <p>For You shall not go out in haste, and You shall not go in flight. For the LORD will go before You, and the God of Israel will be Your rear guard.</p> <p>See, My servant shall act wisely. He shall be raised up and lifted high and greatly exalted.</p> <p>Just as many were appalled at Him — His appearance was so disfigured beyond that of any man, and His form beyond human likeness —</p> <p>so He shall sprinkle many nations. Kings shall shut their mouths because of Him. For what they were not told they shall see, and what they had not heard they shall understand.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 21:27; Isa 51:17; Zech 3:4; Rev 21:2; Isa 51:9
- v2 — Isa 51:14; Jer 51:45; Luke 4:18; Isa 61:1; Jer 51:50
- v3 — 1 Pet 1:18; Isa 45:13; Ps 44:12
- v6 — Ezek 37:13-14; Ezek 20:44; Zech 10:9-12; Heb 8:10-11; Ezek 39:27-29
- v7 — Rom 10:12-15; Nah 1:15; Mark 16:15; Isa 61:1-3; Isa 40:9
- v8 — Isa 62:6; Ezek 33:7; Jer 32:39
- v9 — Isa 51:3; Ps 98:4; Isa 48:20
- v10 — Luke 3:6; Rev 14:6; Rev 15:4; Isa 51:9; Ps 98:1-3
- v11 — 2 Cor 6:17; Zech 2:6-7; Isa 48:20; Eph 5:11; Isa 1:16
- v12 — Isa 58:8; Deut 20:4; Ex 14:19-20; Ex 13:21-22; Isa 45:2

v13 — Matt 28:18; Phil 2:7-11; Isa 42:1; John 3:31; Jer 23:5

v14 — Isa 50:6; Matt 26:67; Isa 53:2-5; Ps 22:17; Ps 22:6-7

Chapter 53

Isaiah prophesies the suffering Servant, despised and rejected of men, a man of sorrows acquainted with grief. He was wounded for our transgressions and bruised for our iniquities; the chastisement of our peace was upon Him, and with His stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray, and the LORD has laid on Him the iniquity of us all. He is led as a lamb to the slaughter, and by His knowledge He shall justify many.

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| 1 | <i>Who hath believed our report? and to whom is the arm of the LORD revealed?</i> | Who has believed what He heard from us? To whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed? |
| 2 | <i>For he shall grow up before him as a tender plant, and as a root out of a dry ground: he hath no form nor comeliness; and when we shall see him, there is no beauty that we should desire him.</i> | He grew up before God like a tender shoot, like a root out of dry ground. He had no form or majesty that we should look at Him, and no beauty that we should desire Him. |
| 3 | <i>He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief: and we hid as it were our faces from him; he was despised, and we esteemed him not.</i> | He is despised and rejected of men — a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. We hid our faces from Him; He was despised, and we did not esteem Him. |
| 4 | <i>Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows: yet we did esteem him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted.</i> | Surely He has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows. Yet we thought He was stricken, struck down by God, and afflicted. |
| 5 | <i>But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.</i> | But He was wounded for our transgressions; He was bruised for our iniquities. The chastisement of our peace was upon Him, and with His stripes we are healed. |
| 6 | <i>All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the LORD hath laid on him the iniquity of us all.</i> | All we like sheep have gone astray. Each of us has turned to his own way. The LORD has laid on Him the iniquity of us all. |

- 7 *He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth: he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he openeth not his mouth.* He was oppressed and He was afflicted, yet He did not open His mouth. He is brought as a lamb to the slaughter. As a sheep before its shearers is silent, so He did not open His mouth.
- 8 *He was taken from prison and from judgment: and who shall declare his generation? for he was cut off out of the land of the living: for the transgression of my people was he stricken.* He was taken away by oppression and judgment. Who will declare His generation? He was cut off from the land of the living. For the transgression of My people He was stricken.
- 9 *And he made his grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death; because he had done no violence, neither was any deceit in his mouth.* He was assigned a grave with the wicked and with a rich man in his death, because He had done no violence and there was no deceit in His mouth.
- 10 *Yet it pleased the LORD to bruise him; he hath put him to grief: when thou shalt make his soul an offering for sin, he shall see his seed, he shall prolong his days, and the pleasure of the LORD shall prosper in his hand.* Yet it pleased the LORD to bruise Him; He has put Him to grief. When You shall make His soul an offering for sin, He shall see His offspring; He shall prolong His days. The purpose of the LORD shall prosper in His hand.
- 11 *He shall see of the travail of his soul, and shall be satisfied: by his knowledge shall my righteous servant justify many; for he shall bear their iniquities.* Out of the anguish of His soul He shall see and be satisfied. By His knowledge My righteous servant shall justify many, for He shall bear their iniquities.

- 12 *Therefore will I divide him a portion with the great, and he shall divide the spoil with the strong; because he hath poured out his soul unto death: and he was numbered with the transgressors; and he bare the sin of many, and made intercession for the transgressors.*
- Therefore I will give Him a portion among the great, and He shall divide the spoil with the strong. Because He poured out His soul to death and was numbered with the transgressors, He bore the sin of many and made intercession for the transgressors.

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

transgression — Crossing the line God set — deliberately breaking a specific command He gave.

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 12:38; Rom 10:16-17; 1 Cor 1:18; John 1:12; Matt 16:17
- v2 — Phil 2:6-7; Isa 52:14; Isa 11:1; John 1:10-14; Mark 6:3
- v3 — John 1:10-11; Matt 26:67; Isa 53:10; Heb 12:2-3; Isa 49:7
- v4 — 1 Pet 2:24; Matt 8:17; Gal 3:13; 1 John 2:2; 1 Pet 3:18
- v5 — 1 Pet 2:24-25; 1 Pet 3:18; Matt 20:28; 2 Cor 5:21; Rom 5:6-10
- v6 — 1 Pet 2:25; 1 Pet 3:18; Ps 119:176; Rom 4:25; Isa 55:7
- v7 — Acts 8:32-33; Matt 26:63; 1 Pet 2:23; Mark 14:61; Matt 27:12-14
- v8 — Acts 8:33; 1 Pet 3:18; John 19:7; Matt 26:65-66; John 11:49-52
- v9 — 1 Pet 2:22; Matt 27:57-60; Mark 15:43-46; 1 John 3:5; 2 Cor 5:21
- v10 — 2 Cor 5:21; Rom 8:32; Gal 3:13; Zech 13:7; Eph 1:5
- v11 — Rom 5:18-19; 1 Pet 2:24; Rev 5:9-10; Isa 53:4-6; John 12:27-32
- v12 — Luke 22:37; Heb 9:28; Mark 15:27; Luke 23:32-34; Col 1:13-14

Chapter 54

The LORD calls the barren woman to sing, for her children will be more than those of the married woman. Her Maker is her husband -- the LORD of hosts is His name -- and He calls her back like a wife forsaken. No weapon formed against her shall prosper, and every tongue that rises against her in judgment she shall condemn.

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| <p>1 <i>Sing, O barren, thou that didst not bear; break forth into singing, and cry aloud, thou that didst not travail with child: for more are the children of the desolate than the children of the married wife, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Enlarge the place of thy tent, and let them stretch forth the curtains of thine habitations: spare not, lengthen thy cords, and strengthen thy stakes;</i></p> <p>3 <i>For thou shalt break forth on the right hand and on the left; and thy seed shall inherit the Gentiles, and make the desolate cities to be inhabited.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Fear not; for thou shalt not be ashamed: neither be thou confounded; for thou shalt not be put to shame: for thou shalt forget the shame of thy youth, and shalt not remember the reproach of thy widowhood any more.</i></p> <p>5 <i>For thy Maker is thine husband; the LORD of hosts is his name; and thy Redeemer the Holy One of Israel; The God of the whole earth shall he be called.</i></p> <p>6 <i>For the LORD hath called thee as a woman forsaken and grieved in spirit, and a wife of youth, when thou wast refused, saith thy God.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For a small moment have I forsaken thee; but with great mercies will I gather thee.</i></p> | <p>Sing, O barren woman — you who did not give birth! Break out into song and cry aloud, You who have never been in labor! For the children of the desolate woman will be more than the children of the married wife, says the LORD.</p> <p>Enlarge the place of Your tent; let the curtains of Your dwelling be stretched out wide. Do not hold back — lengthen Your ropes and drive Your stakes deep.</p> <p>For You will spread out to the right and to the left. Your descendants shall possess the nations and will settle the desolate cities.</p> <p>Do not fear, for You will not be ashamed. Do not be dismayed, for You will not be disgraced. You will forget the shame of Your youth, and You will no longer remember the reproach of Your widowhood.</p> <p>For Your Maker is Your husband — the LORD of hosts is His name. Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel. He shall be called the God of all the earth.</p> <p>For the LORD has called You like a wife forsaken and grieved in spirit — like a young wife when You were rejected, says Your God.</p> <p>For a brief moment I abandoned You, but with great mercies I will gather You.</p> |
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- 8 *In a little wrath I hid my face from thee for a moment; but with everlasting kindness will I have mercy on thee, saith the LORD thy Redeemer.* In a surge of anger I hid My face from You for a moment. But with everlasting kindness I will have mercy on You, says the LORD Your Redeemer.
- 9 *For this is as the waters of Noah unto me: for as I have sworn that the waters of Noah should no more go over the earth; so have I sworn that I would not be wroth with thee, nor rebuke thee.* For this is like the days of Noah to Me. As I swore that the waters of Noah would never again cover the earth, so I have sworn that I will not be angry with you, and will not rebuke you.
- 10 *For the mountains shall depart, and the hills be removed; but my kindness shall not depart from thee, neither shall the covenant of my peace be removed, saith the LORD that hath mercy on thee.* For the mountains may depart and the hills be removed, but My kindness shall not depart from You. My covenant of peace shall not be removed, says the LORD Who has mercy on You.
- 11 *O thou afflicted, tossed with tempest, and not comforted, behold, I will lay thy stones with fair colours, and lay thy foundations with sapphires.* O afflicted city — storm-tossed and not comforted — I will set Your stones in beautiful colors and lay Your foundations with sapphires.
- 12 *And I will make thy windows of agates, and thy gates of carbuncles, and all thy borders of pleasant stones.* I will make Your battlements of rubies, Your gates of jewels, and all Your walls of precious stones.
- 13 *And all thy children shall be taught of the LORD; and great shall be the peace of thy children.* All Your children shall be taught by the LORD, and great shall be the peace of Your children.
- 14 *In righteousness shalt thou be established: thou shalt be far from oppression; for thou shalt not fear: and from terror; for it shall not come near thee.* You shall be established in righteousness. You shall be far from oppression — you shall not fear. You shall be far from terror — it shall not come near You.

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| <p>15 <i>Behold, they shall surely gather together, but not by me: whosoever shall gather together against thee shall fall for thy sake.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Behold, I have created the smith that bloweth the coals in the fire, and that bringeth forth an instrument for his work; and I have created the waster to destroy.</i></p> <p>17 <i>No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper; and every tongue that shall rise against thee in judgment thou shalt condemn. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, and their righteousness is of me, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>If anyone stirs up strife, it is not from Me. Whoever gathers against you shall fall because of you.</p> <p>I have created the craftsman who blows the fire of coals and produces a weapon for His purpose. I have also created the destroyer to cause ruin.</p> <p>No weapon formed against You shall succeed. Every tongue that rises against You in judgment You shall refute. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, and their righteousness is from Me, declares the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gal 4:27; Isa 62:4; 1 Sam 2:5; Heb 11:11-12; Ps 113:9
- v2 — Isa 33:20; Jer 10:20; Isa 49:19-20; Ex 39:40; Ex 35:18
- v4 — Isa 41:10; 1 Pet 2:6; Jer 31:19; Isa 61:7; Isa 45:16-17
- v5 — Eph 5:25-27; Hos 2:19-20; 2 Cor 11:2-3; Isa 48:17; Ezek 16:8
- v6 — Isa 62:4; Hos 2:1-2; Hos 2:14-15; Prov 5:18; Eccl 9:9
- v7 — Ps 30:5; Isa 26:20; Mic 4:6; 2 Pet 3:8; Deut 30:3
- v8 — Jer 31:3; Isa 60:10; 1 Tim 1:16; Ezek 39:23-24; Isa 54:10
- v10 — Ps 89:33-34; Ps 46:2; Eph 2:4-5; Matt 24:35; Rom 11:29
- v13 — John 6:45; Phil 4:7; Ps 119:165; Jer 31:34; Heb 8:10
- v14 — Prov 3:25-26; Jer 30:10; Zech 9:8; Zech 2:4-5; Zech 8:3
- v15 — Isa 41:11-16; Ps 37:12-13; Zech 12:9; Zech 2:8; Isa 43:3-4
- v17 — Rom 8:28-39; Isa 54:15; John 10:28-30; Isa 50:8; Rom 8:1

Chapter 55

The LORD invites everyone who thirsts to come to the waters and buy wine and milk without money and without price. He will make an everlasting covenant with His people -- the sure

mercies of David. His thoughts are higher than man's thoughts, and His word shall not return to Him void but shall accomplish what He pleases.

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| <p>1 <i>Ho, every one that thirsteth, come ye to the waters, and he that hath no money; come ye, buy, and eat; yea, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price.</i></p> | <p>Come, everyone who is thirsty — come to the waters! Even He who has no money — come, buy and eat! Come, buy wine and milk without money and without cost.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Wherefore do ye spend money for that which is not bread? and your labour for that which satisfieth not? hearken diligently unto me, and eat ye that which is good, and let your soul delight itself in fatness.</i></p> | <p>Why do You spend money for what is not bread, and Your wages for what does not satisfy? Listen carefully to Me and eat what is good. Let Your soul delight in rich food.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Incline your ear, and come unto me: hear, and your soul shall live; and I will make an everlasting covenant with you, even the sure mercies of David.</i></p> | <p>Turn your ear and come to Me; listen, that your soul may live! I will make an everlasting covenant with you — the faithful mercies shown to David.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Behold, I have given him for a witness to the people, a leader and commander to the people.</i></p> | <p>I have made him a witness to the peoples, a leader and commander for the peoples.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Behold, thou shalt call a nation that thou knowest not, and nations that knew not thee shall run unto thee because of the LORD thy God, and for the Holy One of Israel; for he hath glorified thee.</i></p> | <p>You shall call a nation You do not know, and a nation that did not know You shall run to You — because of the LORD Your God, the Holy One of Israel, for He has glorified You.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Seek ye the LORD while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near:</i></p> | <p>Seek the LORD while He may be found; call on Him while He is near.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts: and let him return unto the LORD, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon.</i></p> | <p>Let the wicked forsake his way and the unrighteous man His thoughts. Let Him return to the LORD, and He will have mercy on Him — to our God, for He will freely pardon.</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways, and my thoughts than your thoughts.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For as the rain cometh down, and the snow from heaven, and returneth not thither, but watereth the earth, and maketh it bring forth and bud, that it may give seed to the sower, and bread to the eater:</i></p> <p>11 <i>So shall my word be that goeth forth out of my mouth: it shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, and it shall prosper in the thing whereto I sent it.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For ye shall go out with joy, and be led forth with peace: the mountains and the hills shall break forth before you into singing, and all the trees of the field shall clap their hands.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Instead of the thorn shall come up the fir tree, and instead of the brier shall come up the myrtle tree: and it shall be to the LORD for a name, for an everlasting sign that shall not be cut off.</i></p> | <p>"For My thoughts are not Your thoughts, and Your ways are not My ways," declares the LORD.</p> <p>For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are My ways higher than Your ways and My thoughts than Your thoughts.</p> <p>For as the rain and the snow come down from heaven and do not return there, but water the earth and make it bring forth and sprout — giving seed to the sower and bread to the eater —</p> <p>so shall My word be that goes out from My mouth. It shall not return to Me empty; it shall accomplish what I desire and succeed in the thing for which I sent it.</p> <p>For You shall go out with joy and be led forth with peace. The mountains and the hills shall break out into singing before You, and all the trees of the field shall clap their hands.</p> <p>Instead of the thorn shall come up the cypress tree; instead of the brier shall come up the myrtle. This shall be a memorial to the LORD, an everlasting sign that shall not be removed.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v1** — John 7:37-38; Rev 21:6; Rev 22:17; John 4:10-14; Isa 44:3
v2 — John 6:48-58; Jer 2:13; Ps 36:8; Ps 22:26; Rom 10:2-3
v3 — Jer 32:40; Prov 4:20; Matt 11:28; John 10:27; Acts 13:34
v5 — Isa 60:5; Isa 60:9; Zech 2:11; Rom 15:20; Isa 56:8
v6 — Jer 29:12-14; Ps 145:18; Isa 45:19; Ps 32:6; Ps 14:2
v7 — Prov 28:13; Jas 4:8-10; Ezek 18:21-23; Isa 44:22; Luke 15:10
v8 — Ps 92:5; Ps 40:5; Hos 14:9; Ezek 18:29; Ps 25:10
v9 — Rom 11:31-36; Ps 103:11; Matt 11:25; Ps 77:19; Ps 36:5
v10 — 2 Cor 9:9-11; Deut 32:2; Isa 30:23; Ezek 34:26; Hos 10:12
v11 — Matt 24:35; Isa 46:10; Rom 10:17; John 6:63; Isa 45:23
v12 — Gal 5:22; Rom 15:13; Isa 44:23; Ps 105:43; Ps 96:11-13
v13 — Eph 3:20-21; 1 Pet 2:9-10; Isa 41:19; Isa 61:3; Jer 33:9

Chapter 56

The LORD declares that His salvation is near and commands justice and righteousness. The foreigner who joins himself to the LORD shall not be separated from His people, and the eunuch who keeps the LORD's sabbaths will be given a name better than sons and daughters. The LORD's house will be called a house of prayer for all people. Israel's watchmen are blind and her shepherds cannot understand.

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| <p>1 <i>Thus saith the LORD, Keep ye judgment, and do justice: for my salvation is near to come, and my righteousness to be revealed.</i></p> | <p>Thus says the LORD: "Keep justice and do righteousness, for My salvation is near to come and My righteousness to be revealed."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Blessed is the man that doeth this, and the son of man that layeth hold on it; that keepeth the sabbath from polluting it, and keepeth his hand from doing any evil.</i></p> | <p>Blessed is the man who does this — the son of man who holds it firmly — who keeps the Sabbath without defiling it, and keeps His hand from doing any evil.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Neither let the son of the stranger, that hath joined himself to the LORD, speak, saying, The LORD hath utterly separated me from his people: neither let the eunuch say, Behold, I am a dry tree.</i></p> | <p>Let not the foreigner who has joined Himself to the LORD say, "The LORD will surely exclude me from His people." Let not the eunuch say, "I am a dry tree."</p> |

- 4 *For thus saith the LORD unto the eunuchs that keep my sabbaths, and choose the things that please me, and take hold of my covenant;* For thus says the LORD to the eunuchs who keep My Sabbaths, who choose what pleases Me and hold fast to My covenant:
- 5 *Even unto them will I give in mine house and within my walls a place and a name better than of sons and of daughters: I will give them an everlasting name, that shall not be cut off.* "I will give them a memorial and a name within My house and within My walls, better than sons and daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that shall not be cut off."
- 6 *Also the sons of the stranger, that join themselves to the LORD, to serve him, and to love the name of the LORD, to be his servants, every one that keepeth the sabbath from polluting it, and taketh hold of my covenant;* And the foreigners who join themselves to the LORD — to serve Him, to love the name of the LORD, and to be His servants — everyone who keeps the Sabbath without defiling it and holds fast to My covenant —
- 7 *Even them will I bring to my holy mountain, and make them joyful in my house of prayer: their burnt offerings and their sacrifices shall be accepted upon mine altar; for mine house shall be called an house of prayer for all people.* even them I will bring to My holy mountain and make them joyful in My house of prayer. Their burnt offerings and sacrifices shall be accepted on My altar. For My house shall be called a house of prayer for all peoples.
- 8 *The Lord GOD which gathereth the outcasts of Israel saith, Yet will I gather others to him, beside those that are gathered unto him.* The Lord GOD, who gathers the outcasts of Israel, declares: "I will gather still others to Him besides those already gathered."
- 9 *All ye beasts of the field, come to devour, yea, all ye beasts in the forest.* Come to devour, all You animals of the field — all You animals in the forest.
- 10 *His watchmen are blind: they are all ignorant, they are all dumb dogs, they cannot bark; sleeping, lying down, loving to slumber.* His watchmen are blind; they are all without knowledge. They are all silent dogs that cannot bark. They lie down and love to sleep.

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| <p>11 <i>Yea, they are greedy dogs which can never have enough, and they are shepherds that cannot understand: they all look to their own way, every one for his gain, from his quarter.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Come ye, say they, I will fetch wine, and we will fill ourselves with strong drink; and to morrow shall be as this day, and much more abundant.</i></p> | <p>They are greedy dogs with an insatiable appetite. They are shepherds who have no understanding. They all look to their own way, each one seeking his own gain.</p> <p>"Come," each one cries, "let me bring wine; let us drink our fill of strong drink. Tomorrow will be like today — even better!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 13:11-14; Ps 85:9; Matt 3:2; Rom 1:17; Isa 1:16-19
- v2 — Ex 31:13-16; Isa 58:13; Ezek 20:12; Ps 112:1; Ezek 20:20
- v3 — 1 Cor 6:17; Matt 19:12-30; Acts 10:34
- v4 — Luke 10:42; Isa 27:5; Josh 24:15; Ps 119:111
- v5 — Rev 3:12; Rev 3:5; 1 John 3:1; Isa 55:13; 1 Tim 3:15
- v6 — Jer 50:5; Isa 58:13; Isa 56:2-4
- v7 — Mark 11:17; Isa 2:2-3; Mal 1:11; Luke 19:46; Matt 21:13
- v8 — John 10:16; Isa 54:7; Isa 60:3-11
- v10 — Ezek 33:6; Isa 29:10; Phil 3:2; Isa 58:1; Mark 13:34-37
- v11 — Ezek 34:2-3; Ezek 13:19; Mic 3:11; John 8:43; Titus 1:7
- v12 — Ps 10:6; Prov 27:1; Luke 12:19-20; Isa 5:22

Chapter 57

The righteous perish and no one takes it to heart. The LORD rebukes the idolaters who sacrifice children in the valleys and set up their bed on every high mountain. But to the contrite and humble spirit the LORD gives life, for He will not contend forever. He creates the fruit of the lips -- peace to him who is far off and to him who is near. There is no peace for the wicked.

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| <p>1 <i>The righteous perisheth, and no man layeth it to heart: and merciful men are taken away, none considering that the righteous is taken away from the evil to come.</i></p> | <p>The righteous man perishes, and no one takes it to heart. Godly men are taken away, with no one realizing that the righteous man is taken away from the evil that is coming.</p> |
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- 2 *He shall enter into peace: they shall rest in their beds, each one walking in his uprightness.* He enters into peace. They rest in their places — each one who walked in his uprightness.
- 3 *But draw near hither, ye sons of the sorceress, the seed of the adulterer and the whore.* But come here, you children of a sorceress — you offspring of the adulterer and the prostitute.
- 4 *Against whom do ye sport yourselves? against whom make ye a wide mouth, and draw out the tongue? are ye not children of transgression, a seed of falsehood,* Who are you mocking? Against whom do you open your mouth wide and stick out your tongue? Are you not children of transgression, offspring of deceit?
- 5 *Inflaming yourselves with idols under every green tree, burning your children in the valleys under the clefts of the rocks?* You burn with lust among the oaks and under every green tree. You sacrifice your children in the valleys, under the clefts of the rocks.
- 6 *Among the smooth stones of the stream is thy portion; they, they are thy lot: even to them hast thou poured a drink offering, thou hast offered a meat offering. Should I receive comfort in these?* Among the smooth stones of the stream is your portion; they are your lot. To them you have poured out drink offerings and have made grain offerings. Shall I relent for these things?
- 7 *Upon a lofty and high mountain hast thou set thy bed: even thither wentest thou up to offer sacrifice.* On a high and lofty mountain you made your bed. You went up there to offer your sacrifices.
- 8 *Behind the doors also and the posts hast thou set up thy remembrance: for thou hast discovered thyself to another than me, and art gone up; thou hast enlarged thy bed, and made thee a covenant with them; thou lovedst their bed where thou sawest it.* Behind the door and the doorpost you have put your symbol. Turning from Me, you uncovered yourself to another and went up. You enlarged your bed and made a bargain with them. You loved their bed; you chose their open company.

- 9 *And thou wentest to the king with ointment, and didst increase thy perfumes, and didst send thy messengers far off, and didst debase thyself even unto hell.* You journeyed to the king with oil and lavished your perfumes. You sent your ambassadors far away; you sent them down even to the grave.
- 10 *Thou art wearied in the greatness of thy way; yet saidst thou not, There is no hope: thou hast found the life of thine hand; therefore thou wast not grieved.* You were worn out by your many journeys, but you did not say, "It is hopeless." You found renewed strength, and so you were not discouraged.
- 11 *And of whom hast thou been afraid or feared, that thou hast lied, and hast not remembered me, nor laid it to thy heart? have not I held my peace even of old, and thou fearest me not?* Whom have you feared and been in awe of, that you have lied and not remembered Me, not taken Me to heart? Was I not silent for a long time, and so you do not fear Me?
- 12 *I will declare thy righteousness, and thy works; for they shall not profit thee.* I will expose your so-called righteousness and your deeds — they will not help you.
- 13 *When thou criest, let thy companies deliver thee; but the wind shall carry them all away; vanity shall take them: but he that putteth his trust in me shall possess the land, and shall inherit my holy mountain;* When you cry out, let your collection of idols deliver you! But the wind will carry them all away; a breath will take them. But he who takes refuge in Me shall possess the land and shall inherit My holy mountain.
- 14 *And shall say, Cast ye up, cast ye up, prepare the way, take up the stumblingblock out of the way of my people.* He shall say: "Build up, build up — prepare the way! Remove every stumbling block from the road for My people."
- 15 *For thus saith the high and lofty One that inhabiteth eternity, whose name is Holy; I dwell in the high and holy place, with him also that is of a contrite and humble spirit, to revive the spirit of the humble, and to revive the heart of the contrite ones.* For thus says the One who is high and lifted up — who inhabits eternity, whose name is Holy: "I live in the high and holy place, and also with the one who is contrite and humble in spirit — to revive the spirit of the humble and to revive the heart of the contrite."

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| <p>16 <i>For I will not contend for ever,
neither will I be always wroth: for the
spirit should fail before me, and the
souls which I have made.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For the iniquity of his covetousness
was I wroth, and smote him: I hid me,
and was wroth, and he went on
frowardly in the way of his heart.</i></p> <p>18 <i>I have seen his ways, and will heal
him: I will lead him also, and restore
comforts unto him and to his
mourners.</i></p> <p>19 <i>I create the fruit of the lips; Peace,
peace to him that is far off, and to him
that is near, saith the LORD; and I
will heal him.</i></p> <p>20 <i>But the wicked are like the troubled
sea, when it cannot rest, whose waters
cast up mire and dirt.</i></p> <p>21 <i>There is no peace, saith my God, to
the wicked.</i></p> | <p>For I will not contend forever, nor will
I always be angry. For the spirit would
grow faint before Me — the souls I
have made.</p> <p>Because of his iniquitous covetousness
I was angry; I struck him and hid My
face in anger. But he kept going back
to the ways of his own heart.</p> <p>I have seen his ways, but I will heal
him. I will lead him and restore
comfort to him and his mourners.</p> <p>I create the fruit of the lips. Peace,
peace to the one who is far and to the
one who is near, says the LORD. I will
heal Him.</p> <p>But the wicked are like the troubled
sea — it cannot be quiet, and its waters
toss up mud and mire.</p> <p>"There is no peace," says my God, "for
the wicked."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Kgs 22:20; Ps 12:1; 2 Chr 34:28; Mic 7:2; Isa 42:25
v2 — Rev 14:13; 2 Cor 5:1; Luke 2:29; Job 3:17; 2 Cor 5:8
v3 — 1 John 3:10; Matt 16:4
v11 — Isa 51:12-13; Ps 50:21; Prov 29:25
v13 — Ps 37:9; Ps 37:3
v14 — Isa 62:10; Luke 3:5-6; Isa 35:8; Isa 40:3; Jer 18:15
v15 — Ps 34:18; Isa 66:1-2; Ps 138:6; Ps 147:3; Ex 15:11
v16 — Mic 7:18; Jer 10:24; Ps 85:5; Ps 103:9-16; Heb 12:9
v18 — Jer 33:6; Rev 7:17; Jer 3:22; Hos 14:4-8; Jer 31:3
v19 — Acts 2:39; Heb 13:15; Luke 10:5-6; Acts 10:36; Eph 6:19

v20 — Isa 3:11; Prov 4:16-17; Job 18:5-14

v21 — Isa 48:22; Isa 3:11

Chapter 58

The LORD rebukes Israel's fasts as empty rituals done for show while they oppress their workers. The true fast is to loose the bonds of wickedness, feed the hungry, clothe the naked, and take in the homeless poor. Then their light will break forth as the morning, and the LORD will guide them continually and satisfy their soul in drought.

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| <p>1 Cry aloud, spare not, lift up thy voice like a trumpet, and shew my people their transgression, and the house of Jacob their sins.</p> | <p>Cry out loudly; do not hold back! Lift up your voice like a trumpet. Declare to My people their transgression and to the house of Jacob their sins.</p> |
| <p>2 Yet they seek me daily, and delight to know my ways, as a nation that did righteousness, and forsook not the ordinance of their God: they ask of me the ordinances of justice; they take delight in approaching to God.</p> | <p>Yet they seek Me daily and delight to know My ways, as if they were a nation that did righteousness and did not forsake the ordinances of their God. They ask Me for just decisions; they delight in drawing near to God.</p> |
| <p>3 Wherefore have we fasted, say they, and thou seest not? wherefore have we afflicted our soul, and thou takest no knowledge? Behold, in the day of your fast ye find pleasure, and exact all your labours.</p> | <p>"Why have we fasted and You do not see?" they say. "Why have we humbled ourselves and You take no notice?" Look — on the day of your fasting you pursue your own pleasure and oppress all your workers.</p> |
| <p>4 Behold, ye fast for strife and debate, and to smite with the fist of wickedness: ye shall not fast as ye do this day, to make your voice to be heard on high.</p> | <p>You fast for strife and argument and to strike with a wicked fist. You do not fast as you do this day if you want your voice to be heard on high.</p> |
| <p>5 Is it such a fast that I have chosen? a day for a man to afflict his soul? is it to bow down his head as a bulrush, and to spread sackcloth and ashes under him? wilt thou call this a fast, and an acceptable day to the LORD?</p> | <p>Is this the fast I have chosen — a day for a man to humble himself? Is it to bow his head like a reed and to spread sackcloth and ashes? Will You call this a fast — a day acceptable to the LORD?</p> |

- 6 *Is not this the fast that I have chosen? to loose the bands of wickedness, to undo the heavy burdens, and to let the oppressed go free, and that ye break every yoke?* Is this not the fast I have chosen: to break the chains of injustice and untie the cords of the yoke — to set the oppressed free and to break every yoke?
- 7 *Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him; and that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh?* Is it not to share Your bread with the hungry and to bring the homeless poor into Your house — to cover the naked when You see them and not to turn away from Your own kin?
- 8 *Then shall thy light break forth as the morning, and thine health shall spring forth speedily: and thy righteousness shall go before thee; the glory of the LORD shall be thy rereward.* Then Your light shall break out like the dawn. Your healing shall spring up quickly. Your righteousness shall go before You; the glory of the LORD shall be Your rear guard.
- 9 *Then shalt thou call, and the LORD shall answer; thou shalt cry, and he shall say, Here I am. If thou take away from the midst of thee the yoke, the putting forth of the finger, and speaking vanity;* Then You shall call, and the LORD will answer. You shall cry, and He will say, "Here I am." If You remove the yoke from Your midst, the pointing of the finger, and speaking wickedness,
- 10 *And if thou draw out thy soul to the hungry, and satisfy the afflicted soul; then shall thy light rise in obscurity, and thy darkness be as the noon day:* and if You pour Yourself out for the hungry and satisfy the desire of the afflicted — then Your light shall rise in the darkness, and Your gloom shall be as the noonday.
- 11 *And the LORD shall guide thee continually, and satisfy thy soul in drought, and make fat thy bones: and thou shalt be like a watered garden, and like a spring of water, whose waters fail not.* The LORD will guide You continually and satisfy Your soul in dry times and make Your bones strong. You shall be like a watered garden, like a spring of water whose waters do not fail.

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| <p>12 <i>And they that shall be of thee shall build the old waste places: thou shalt raise up the foundations of many generations; and thou shalt be called, The repairer of the breach, The restorer of paths to dwell in.</i></p> <p>13 <i>If thou turn away thy foot from the sabbath, from doing thy pleasure on my holy day; and call the sabbath a delight, the holy of the LORD, honourable; and shalt honour him, not doing thine own ways, nor finding thine own pleasure, nor speaking thine own words:</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then shalt thou delight thyself in the LORD; and I will cause thee to ride upon the high places of the earth, and feed thee with the heritage of Jacob thy father: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.</i></p> | <p>Your people shall build up the ancient ruins; You shall raise up the age-old foundations. You shall be called the Repairer of the Breach, the Restorer of Streets to dwell in.</p> <p>If You turn back Your foot from the Sabbath — from doing Your pleasure on My holy day — and call the Sabbath a delight and the LORD's holy day honorable; if You honor it by not going Your own ways or seeking Your own pleasure or speaking Your own words,</p> <p>then You shall take delight in the LORD. I will make You ride on the heights of the earth; I will feed You with the heritage of Jacob your father. The mouth of the LORD has spoken.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Titus 2:15; Hos 8:1; Acts 20:26-27; Ezek 3:17-21; Acts 7:51-52
- v2 — Titus 1:16; Isa 29:13; Matt 15:7-9
- v5 — Dan 9:3-19; Zech 7:5; Isa 49:8; Esth 4:16; Isa 61:2
- v6 — Neh 5:10-12; Isa 58:9; Jer 34:8-11; 1 Tim 6:1
- v7 — Matt 25:35-45; Ezek 18:7; Luke 3:11; 1 John 3:17-18; Prov 28:27
- v8 — Isa 52:12; Jer 33:6; Ps 37:6; Jer 30:17; Mal 4:2
- v9 — Ps 50:15; Jer 29:12-13; Isa 65:24; Ps 91:15; Matt 7:7-8
- v10 — Prov 11:24-25; Ps 37:6; Isa 42:16; Isa 58:7-8; Job 11:17
- v11 — John 4:14; Ps 32:8; Jer 31:12; Isa 49:10; John 16:13
- v12 — Isa 61:4; Ezek 36:33; Amos 9:14; Neh 2:17; Amos 9:11
- v13 — Jer 17:21-27; Ps 92:1-2; Isa 56:2-6; Neh 13:15-22; Rev 1:10
- v14 — Deut 32:13; Job 22:26; Hab 3:18-19; Isa 33:16; Isa 1:19-20

Chapter 59

Isaiah declares that the LORD's hand is not shortened that it cannot save, but Israel's iniquities have separated them from God. Justice is far from them, truth has fallen in the street, and the LORD saw that there was no intercessor, so His own arm brought salvation. The Redeemer shall come to Zion, and the LORD's covenant promises that His Spirit and His words shall not depart from their mouth forever.

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| 1 <i>Behold, the LORD'S hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; neither his ear heavy, that it cannot hear:</i> | The LORD's arm is not too short to save; His ear is not too dull to hear. |
| 2 <i>But your iniquities have separated between you and your God, and your sins have hid his face from you, that he will not hear.</i> | But Your iniquities have separated You from Your God. Your sins have hidden His face from You, so that He does not hear. |
| 3 <i>For your hands are defiled with blood, and your fingers with iniquity; your lips have spoken lies, your tongue hath muttered perverseness.</i> | Your hands are defiled with blood, Your fingers with iniquity. Your lips have spoken lies; Your tongue mutters wickedness. |
| 4 <i>None calleth for justice, nor any pleadeth for truth: they trust in vanity, and speak lies; they conceive mischief, and bring forth iniquity.</i> | No one calls for justice; no one pleads truthfully. They trust in empty talk and speak lies. They conceive trouble and give birth to iniquity. |
| 5 <i>They hatch cockatrice' eggs, and weave the spider's web: he that eateth of their eggs dieth, and that which is crushed breaketh out into a viper.</i> | They hatch the eggs of vipers and spin a spider's web. Whoever eats their eggs dies, and when one is cracked, a poisonous snake hatches. |
| 6 <i>Their webs shall not become garments, neither shall they cover themselves with their works: their works are works of iniquity, and the act of violence is in their hands.</i> | Their webs cannot be used as clothing; their deeds cannot cover themselves. Their works are works of iniquity, and acts of violence are in their hands. |
| 7 <i>Their feet run to evil, and they make haste to shed innocent blood: their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity; wasting and destruction are in their paths.</i> | Their feet run to evil; they rush to shed innocent blood. Their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity; ruin and destruction are in their paths. |

- 8 *The way of peace they know not; and there is no judgment in their goings: they have made them crooked paths: whosoever goeth therein shall not know peace.* The way of peace they do not know; there is no justice in their paths. They have made their roads crooked; no one who walks on them knows peace.
- 9 *Therefore is judgment far from us, neither doth justice overtake us: we wait for light, but behold obscurity; for brightness, but we walk in darkness.* Therefore justice is far from us, and righteousness does not reach us. We look for light, but find darkness; we look for brightness, but walk in deep shadow.
- 10 *We grope for the wall like the blind, and we grope as if we had no eyes: we stumble at noonday as in the night; we are in desolate places as dead men.* We grope along the wall like the blind; we grope like those who have no eyes. We stumble at midday as in the twilight; among the healthy we are like the dead.
- 11 *We roar all like bears, and mourn sore like doves: we look for judgment, but there is none; for salvation, but it is far off from us.* We growl like bears; we moan mournfully like doves. We look for justice, but there is none; for salvation, but it is far from us.
- 12 *For our transgressions are multiplied before thee, and our sins testify against us: for our transgressions are with us; and as for our iniquities, we know them;* For our transgressions are many before You, and our sins testify against us. Our transgressions are with us, and we know our iniquities —
- 13 *In transgressing and lying against the LORD, and departing away from our God, speaking oppression and revolt, conceiving and uttering from the heart words of falsehood.* transgressing and denying the LORD, turning away from our God — speaking oppression and revolt, conceiving and speaking lies from the heart.
- 14 *And judgment is turned away backward, and justice standeth afar off: for truth is fallen in the street, and equity cannot enter.* Justice is turned back, and righteousness stands far away. Truth has stumbled in the public square, and honesty cannot enter.

- 15 *Yea, truth faileth; and he that departeth from evil maketh himself a prey: and the LORD saw it, and it displeased him that there was no judgment.* Truth is missing; whoever turns from evil becomes a target. The LORD saw it, and it displeased Him that there was no justice.
- 16 *And he saw that there was no man, and wondered that there was no intercessor: therefore his arm brought salvation unto him; and his righteousness, it sustained him.* He saw that there was no man, and was appalled that there was no one to intercede. So his own arm brought salvation to Him, and His righteousness sustained Him.
- 17 *For he put on righteousness as a breastplate, and an helmet of salvation upon his head; and he put on the garments of vengeance for clothing, and was clad with zeal as a cloke.* He put on righteousness as a breastplate and a helmet of salvation on His head. He put on the garments of vengeance as His clothing, and wrapped Himself in zeal as a cloak.
- 18 *According to their deeds, accordingly he will repay, fury to his adversaries, recompence to his enemies; to the islands he will repay recompence.* According to their deeds, so He will repay — wrath to His adversaries, repayment to His enemies. To the distant shores He will render repayment.
- 19 *So shall they fear the name of the LORD from the west, and his glory from the rising of the sun. When the enemy shall come in like a flood, the Spirit of the LORD shall lift up a standard against him.* So they shall fear the name of the LORD from the west, and His glory from the rising of the sun. When the enemy comes in like a flood, the Spirit of the LORD shall lift up an ensign against Him.
- 20 *And the Redeemer shall come to Zion, and unto them that turn from transgression in Jacob, saith the LORD.* The Redeemer shall come to Zion — to those in Jacob who turn from transgression, declares the LORD.

- 21 *As for me, this is my covenant with them, saith the LORD; My spirit that is upon thee, and my words which I have put in thy mouth, shall not depart out of thy mouth, nor out of the mouth of thy seed, nor out of the mouth of thy seed's seed, saith the LORD, from henceforth and for ever.* "And as for Me, this is My covenant with them," says the LORD: "My Spirit who is on You and My words that I have put in Your mouth shall not depart from Your mouth, or from the mouth of Your children, or from the mouth of Your children's children," says the LORD, "from now on and forever."

Words in this chapter:

breastplate — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 32:17; Isa 50:2; Num 11:23; Isa 65:24; Gen 18:14
v2 — Jer 5:25; Prov 15:29; Mic 3:4; Isa 1:15; Deut 31:17-18
v4 — Job 15:35; Mic 7:2-5; Jas 1:15; Jer 7:8; Jer 7:4
v7 — Rom 3:15-17; Prov 6:17; Prov 1:16; Mark 7:21-22
v8 — Isa 57:20-21; Rom 3:17; Ps 58:1-2; Luke 1:79; Isa 5:7
v14 — Hab 1:4; Eccl 3:16; Isa 10:1-2; Jer 5:31; Mic 3:9-11
v16 — Ezek 22:30; Ps 98:1; Isa 64:7; Ps 106:23; Isa 63:3-5
v17 — Eph 6:17; Eph 6:14; 1 Thess 5:8; Rom 13:12-14; Isa 11:5
v18 — Jer 17:10; Isa 63:6; Rom 2:6; Matt 16:27
v19 — Dan 7:27; Ps 113:3; Zech 4:6; Rev 12:15-17; Rev 17:14-15
v20 — Rom 11:26-27; Titus 2:11-14; Acts 3:19; Ezek 18:30-31; Heb 12:14
v21 — Jer 31:31-34; Heb 10:16; Ezek 36:25-27; Jer 32:38-41; Heb 8:6-13

Chapter 60

Isaiah calls Zion to arise and shine, for her light has come and the glory of the LORD has risen upon her. Nations will come to her light and kings to the brightness of her rising. The wealth of the nations will flow to her, the sun will no longer be needed for light, and the LORD Himself will be her everlasting light.

- 1 *Arise, shine; for thy light is come, and the glory of the LORD is risen upon thee.* Arise, shine, for Your light has come! The glory of the LORD has risen on You.

- 2 *For, behold, the darkness shall cover the earth, and gross darkness the people: but the LORD shall arise upon thee, and his glory shall be seen upon thee.* For darkness shall cover the earth and thick darkness the peoples, but the LORD will rise on You, and His glory will be seen on You.
- 3 *And the Gentiles shall come to thy light, and kings to the brightness of thy rising.* Nations shall come to Your light, and kings to the brightness of Your rising.
- 4 *Lift up thine eyes round about, and see: all they gather themselves together, they come to thee: thy sons shall come from far, and thy daughters shall be nursed at thy side.* Lift up Your eyes and look around — all of them gather and come to You. Your sons shall come from far away, and Your daughters shall be carried at Your side.
- 5 *Then thou shalt see, and flow together, and thine heart shall fear, and be enlarged; because the abundance of the sea shall be converted unto thee, the forces of the Gentiles shall come unto thee.* Then You shall see and be radiant; Your heart shall thrill and overflow. For the wealth of the sea shall be brought to You; the riches of the nations shall come to you.
- 6 *The multitude of camels shall cover thee, the dromedaries of Midian and Ephah; all they from Sheba shall come: they shall bring gold and incense; and they shall shew forth the praises of the LORD.* A great number of camels shall cover You — the young camels of Midian and Ephah. All those from Sheba shall come; they shall bring gold and frankincense and shall proclaim the praises of the LORD.
- 7 *All the flocks of Kedar shall be gathered together unto thee, the rams of Nebaioth shall minister unto thee: they shall come up with acceptance on mine altar, and I will glorify the house of my glory.* All the flocks of Kedar shall be gathered to You; the rams of Nebaioth shall serve You. They shall come up with acceptance on My altar, and I will glorify My glorious house.
- 8 *Who are these that fly as a cloud, and as the doves to their windows?* Who are these who fly like a cloud, like doves to their perches?

- 9 *Surely the isles shall wait for me, and the ships of Tarshish first, to bring thy sons from far, their silver and their gold with them, unto the name of the LORD thy God, and to the Holy One of Israel, because he hath glorified thee.* Surely the coastlands wait for Me — the ships of Tarshish first — to bring Your sons from far away, their silver and gold with them, to the name of the LORD Your God, and to the Holy One of Israel, for He has glorified You.
- 10 *And the sons of strangers shall build up thy walls, and their kings shall minister unto thee: for in my wrath I smote thee, but in my favour have I had mercy on thee.* Foreigners shall build Your walls, and their kings shall serve You. For in My anger I struck You, but in My favor I have had mercy on You.
- 11 *Therefore thy gates shall be open continually; they shall not be shut day nor night; that men may bring unto thee the forces of the Gentiles, and that their kings may be brought.* Your gates shall always be open; day and night they shall not be shut — that people may bring You the wealth of the nations, with their kings being led in procession.
- 12 *For the nation and kingdom that will not serve thee shall perish; yea, those nations shall be utterly wasted.* For the nation and kingdom that will not serve you shall perish. Those nations shall be completely destroyed.
- 13 *The glory of Lebanon shall come unto thee, the fir tree, the pine tree, and the box together, to beautify the place of my sanctuary; and I will make the place of my feet glorious.* The glory of Lebanon shall come to You — the cypress, the plane tree, and the pine — to beautify the place of My sanctuary. I will make the place of My feet glorious.
- 14 *The sons also of them that afflicted thee shall come bending unto thee; and all they that despised thee shall bow themselves down at the soles of thy feet; and they shall call thee, The city of the LORD, The Zion of the Holy One of Israel.* The descendants of those who tormented You shall come bowing down to You. All who despised You shall bow at Your feet. They shall call You the City of the LORD, the Zion of the Holy One of Israel.

- 15 *Whereas thou hast been forsaken and hated, so that no man went through thee, I will make thee an eternal excellency, a joy of many generations.* Because You have been forsaken and hated — with no one passing through — I will make you a pride forever, a joy from age to age.
- 16 *Thou shalt also suck the milk of the Gentiles, and shalt suck the breast of kings: and thou shalt know that I the LORD am thy Saviour and thy Redeemer, the mighty One of Jacob.* You shall drink the milk of nations; You shall nurse at the breast of kings. You shall know that I, the LORD, am Your Savior and Your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob.
- 17 *For brass I will bring gold, and for iron I will bring silver, and for wood brass, and for stones iron: I will also make thy officers peace, and thine exactors righteousness.* Instead of bronze I will bring gold; instead of iron I will bring silver; instead of wood, bronze; instead of stones, iron. I will make Your officers peace and Your rulers righteousness.
- 18 *Violence shall no more be heard in thy land, wasting nor destruction within thy borders; but thou shalt call thy walls Salvation, and thy gates Praise.* Violence shall no more be heard in Your land, nor devastation or destruction within Your borders. You shall call Your walls Salvation and Your gates Praise.
- 19 *The sun shall be no more thy light by day; neither for brightness shall the moon give light unto thee: but the LORD shall be unto thee an everlasting light, and thy God thy glory.* The sun shall no longer be Your light by day, nor shall the moon give You its brightness by night. But the LORD shall be Your everlasting light, and Your God shall be Your glory.
- 20 *Thy sun shall no more go down; neither shall thy moon withdraw itself: for the LORD shall be thine everlasting light, and the days of thy mourning shall be ended.* Your sun shall no longer go down, and Your moon shall not withdraw. For the LORD shall be Your everlasting light, and the days of Your mourning shall be over.
- 21 *Thy people also shall be all righteous: they shall inherit the land for ever, the branch of my planting, the work of my hands, that I may be glorified.* Your people shall all be righteous; they shall possess the land forever. They are the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, that I may be glorified.

- 22 *A little one shall become a thousand, and a small one a strong nation: I the LORD will hasten it in his time.* The smallest shall become a thousand, and the least shall become a mighty nation. I am the LORD; in its time I will do this quickly.
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Words in this chapter:

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eph 5:14; Eph 5:8; John 8:12; Isa 52:1-2; Isa 60:19-20
v2 — Col 1:13; 1 Pet 2:9; Acts 17:30-31; Eph 4:17-20; 2 Cor 4:4-6
v3 — Acts 13:47; Isa 49:23; Rev 21:24; Mic 4:1-2; Isa 2:2-5
v6 — Matt 2:11; Ps 72:10; Ps 72:15; 1 Pet 2:9; Judg 6:5
v10 — Isa 61:5; Isa 49:23; Rev 21:26; Isa 14:1-2; Isa 54:7-8
v14 — Rev 3:9; Isa 49:23; Isa 45:14; Heb 12:22; Isa 62:12
v15 — Isa 61:7; Jer 30:17; Isa 49:14-23; Isa 35:10; Jer 33:11
v16 — Isa 49:23; Isa 66:14; Isa 66:11-12; Isa 61:6; Isa 43:3-4
v18 — Isa 26:1; Isa 11:9; Zech 9:8; Ps 72:3-7; Isa 2:4
v19 — Rev 21:23; Rev 22:5; Zech 2:5; Ps 36:9; Ps 3:3
v20 — Rev 21:4; Ps 84:11; Isa 35:10; Ps 27:1; Mal 4:2
v22 — Hab 2:3; Heb 10:36; Luke 18:7; Matt 13:31-32; Isa 66:8

Chapter 61

The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon the Servant to preach good tidings to the poor, to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and to declare the acceptable year of the LORD and the day of vengeance. The LORD will give them beauty for ashes, the oil of joy for mourning, and the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness.

- 1 *The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound;*

The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to bring good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim freedom to the captives and opening of the prison to those who are bound,
- 2 *To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, and the day of vengeance of our God; to comfort all that mourn;*

to proclaim the year of the LORD's favor and the day of vengeance of our God — to comfort all who mourn,
- 3 *To appoint unto them that mourn in Zion, to give unto them beauty for ashes, the oil of joy for mourning, the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness; that they might be called trees of righteousness, the planting of the LORD, that he might be glorified.*

to grant to those who mourn in Zion — to give them a crown of beauty instead of ashes, the oil of joy instead of mourning, the garment of praise instead of a spirit of despair. They shall be called oaks of righteousness, the planting of the LORD, that He may be glorified.
- 4 *And they shall build the old wastes, they shall raise up the former desolations, and they shall repair the waste cities, the desolations of many generations.*

They shall build up the ancient ruins; they shall raise up the former desolations. They shall repair the ruined cities, the devastations of many generations.
- 5 *And strangers shall stand and feed your flocks, and the sons of the alien shall be your plowmen and your vinedressers.*

Strangers shall stand and tend Your flocks; foreigners shall be Your farmers and vinedressers.
- 6 *But ye shall be named the Priests of the LORD: men shall call you the Ministers of our God: ye shall eat the riches of the Gentiles, and in their glory shall ye boast yourselves.*

But You shall be called the Priests of the LORD; You shall be spoken of as the Ministers of our God. You shall eat the wealth of the nations and in their riches you shall boast.

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| <p>7 <i>For your shame ye shall have double; and for confusion they shall rejoice in their portion: therefore in their land they shall possess the double: everlasting joy shall be unto them.</i></p> | <p>Instead of your shame there shall be a double portion; instead of dishonor they shall rejoice in their lot. Therefore in their land they shall possess a double portion; everlasting joy shall be theirs.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>For I the LORD love judgment, I hate robbery for burnt offering; and I will direct their work in truth, and I will make an everlasting covenant with them.</i></p> | <p>For I the LORD love justice; I hate robbery and wrongdoing. I will faithfully give them their reward, and I will make an everlasting covenant with them.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And their seed shall be known among the Gentiles, and their offspring among the people: all that see them shall acknowledge them, that they are the seed which the LORD hath blessed.</i></p> | <p>Their descendants shall be known among the nations, and their offspring among the peoples. All who see them shall acknowledge them — that they are a people the LORD has blessed.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>I will greatly rejoice in the LORD, my soul shall be joyful in my God; for he hath clothed me with the garments of salvation, he hath covered me with the robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom decketh himself with ornaments, and as a bride adorneth herself with her jewels.</i></p> | <p>I will greatly rejoice in the LORD; my soul shall be joyful in my God. For He has clothed me with garments of salvation; He has covered me with a robe of righteousness — as a bridegroom adorns Himself with a crown, and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>For as the earth bringeth forth her bud, and as the garden causeth the things that are sown in it to spring forth; so the Lord GOD will cause righteousness and praise to spring forth before all the nations.</i></p> | <p>For as the earth brings forth its growth, and as a garden causes what is sown in it to sprout up, so the Lord GOD will cause righteousness and praise to spring up before all the nations.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 4:18-19; Luke 7:22; Isa 42:7; Matt 11:5; Ps 147:3

v2 — Matt 5:4; Isa 34:8; Luke 4:19; Isa 57:18; 2 Thess 2:16-17

v3 — Ps 30:11; Jer 17:7-8; John 16:20; Isa 61:10; Ps 45:7

v4 — Isa 58:12; Amos 9:14-15; Ezek 36:33-36; Ezek 36:23-26; Isa 49:6-8

v5 — Isa 60:10-14; Isa 14:1-2

v6 — Ex 19:6; 1 Pet 2:9; 1 Pet 2:5; Isa 60:5-7; Rev 5:10

v7 — Job 42:10; Zech 9:12; Isa 40:2; Isa 60:19-20; Ps 16:11

v8 — Ps 11:7; Jer 9:24; Zech 8:16-17; Jer 32:40; Isa 55:3

v9 — Isa 44:3; Ps 115:14; Acts 3:26; Gen 22:18

v10 — Rev 19:7-8; Phil 3:9; Ps 132:9; Ps 132:16; Rev 21:2

v11 — Mark 4:26-32; Isa 58:11; 1 Pet 2:9; Isa 55:10-11; Isa 62:1

Chapter 62

Isaiah declares he will not rest until the righteousness of Zion goes forth as brightness and her salvation as a lamp that burns. She shall be called by a new name, and the LORD will rejoice over her as a bridegroom rejoices over his bride. Watchmen are set on the walls of Jerusalem who shall never hold their peace day or night.

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| <p>¹ <i>For Zion's sake will I not hold my peace, and for Jerusalem's sake I will not rest, until the righteousness thereof go forth as brightness, and the salvation thereof as a lamp that burneth.</i></p> | <p>For Zion's sake I will not keep silent, and for Jerusalem's sake I will not be still, until her righteousness goes out like brightness and her salvation burns like a torch.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And the Gentiles shall see thy righteousness, and all kings thy glory: and thou shalt be called by a new name, which the mouth of the LORD shall name.</i></p> | <p>The nations shall see your righteousness, and all kings shall see Your glory. You shall be called by a new name that the mouth of the LORD will give.</p> |

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| <p>3 <i>Thou shalt also be a crown of glory in the hand of the LORD, and a royal diadem in the hand of thy God.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Thou shalt no more be termed Forsaken; neither shall thy land any more be termed Desolate: but thou shalt be called Hephzibah, and thy land Beulah: for the LORD delighteth in thee, and thy land shall be married.</i></p> | <p>You shall be a crown of beauty in the hand of the LORD, and a royal headband in the hand of Your God.</p> <p>You shall no more be called Forsaken, and Your land shall no more be called Desolate. But You shall be called Hephzibah, and Your land shall be called Beulah. For the LORD delights in You, and Your land shall be married.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hephzibah** (HEF-zih-bah) — "My delight is in her" — the new name God gives to restored Zion, symbolizing His love and delight in His people.

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| <p>5 <i>For as a young man marieth a virgin, so shall thy sons marry thee: and as the bridegroom rejoiceth over the bride, so shall thy God rejoice over thee.</i></p> <p>6 <i>I have set watchmen upon thy walls, O Jerusalem, which shall never hold their peace day nor night: ye that make mention of the LORD, keep not silence,</i></p> <p>7 <i>And give him no rest, till he establish, and till he make Jerusalem a praise in the earth.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The LORD hath sworn by his right hand, and by the arm of his strength, Surely I will no more give thy corn to be meat for thine enemies; and the sons of the stranger shall not drink thy wine, for the which thou hast laboured:</i></p> | <p>As a young man marries a young woman, so shall Your sons marry You. As the bridegroom rejoices over the bride, so shall Your God rejoice over You.</p> <p>On Your walls, O Jerusalem, I have set watchmen. All day and all night they shall never be silent. You who call on the LORD, give yourselves no rest, and give Him no rest until He establishes Jerusalem and makes it a praise in all the earth.</p> <p>The LORD has sworn by His right hand and by His mighty arm: "I will not again give Your grain to be food for Your enemies, and foreigners shall not drink Your wine for which You have labored.</p> |
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| <p>9 <i>But they that have gathered it shall eat it, and praise the LORD; and they that have brought it together shall drink it in the courts of my holiness.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Go through, go through the gates; prepare ye the way of the people; cast up, cast up the highway; gather out the stones; lift up a standard for the people.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Behold, the LORD hath proclaimed unto the end of the world, Say ye to the daughter of Zion, Behold, thy salvation cometh; behold, his reward is with him, and his work before him.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And they shall call them, The holy people, The redeemed of the LORD: and thou shalt be called, Sought out, A city not forsaken.</i></p> | <p>But those who harvest it shall eat it and praise the LORD, and those who gather it shall drink it in the courts of My sanctuary."</p> <p>Go through, go through the gates. Prepare the way for the people. Build up, build up the highway. Clear out the stones; lift up an ensign for the people.</p> <p>The LORD has proclaimed to the end of the earth: "Say to the daughter of Zion, 'Your salvation is coming. His reward is with Him, and His work goes before Him.'"</p> <p>They shall be called the Holy People, the Redeemed of the LORD. You shall be called Sought Out, a City Not Forsaken.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

ensign — A signal banner or rallying flag — lifted high to gather troops or nations; used in prophecy for the Messiah drawing all peoples.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 62:6-7; Prov 4:18; Isa 32:15-17; Ps 102:13-16; Luke 2:30-32

v2 — Isa 62:12; Gen 17:5; Rev 2:17; Isa 65:15; Isa 60:1-3

v3 — Isa 28:5; 1 Thess 2:19; Zech 9:16

v4 — Zeph 3:17; Hos 2:19-20; Isa 62:12; Isa 54:5-7; Jer 32:41

v5 — Isa 62:4; Isa 65:19; Heb 12:2

- v6** — Isa 52:8; Ezek 3:17-21; 1 Thess 5:17; Ps 134:1-2; Jer 6:17
v7 — Jer 33:9; Zeph 3:19-20; Isa 60:18; Luke 18:1-8; Matt 6:9-10
v8 — Isa 65:21-23; Judg 6:3-6; Deut 28:33; Deut 28:31; Ezek 20:5
v9 — Deut 16:11
v10 — Isa 57:14; Isa 40:3; Isa 49:22; Heb 12:13; Isa 11:10
v11 — Zech 9:9; Matt 21:5; John 12:15; Rev 22:12; Isa 40:9-10
v12 — 1 Pet 2:9; Isa 62:4; Deut 26:19; Deut 28:9; Isa 35:9

Chapter 63

Isaiah sees one coming from Edom with garments stained red, who has trodden the winepress of God's wrath alone. Isaiah recounts the LORD's lovingkindness and mercies toward Israel, how He carried them in the days of old and how they grieved His Holy Spirit. He prays for the LORD to look down from heaven and return for His people.

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| <p>1 <i>Who is this that cometh from Edom, with dyed garments from Bozrah? this that is glorious in his apparel, travelling in the greatness of his strength? I that speak in righteousness, mighty to save.</i></p> | <p>Who is this who comes from Edom, in crimsoned garments from Bozrah — this One who is glorious in His clothing, marching in the greatness of His strength? "It is I, speaking in righteousness, mighty to save."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Wherefore art thou red in thine apparel, and thy garments like him that treadeth in the winefat?</i></p> | <p>Why is Your clothing red, and Your garments like one who treads in the winepress?</p> |
| <p>3 <i>I have trodden the winepress alone; and of the people there was none with me: for I will tread them in mine anger, and trample them in my fury; and their blood shall be sprinkled upon my garments, and I will stain all my raiment.</i></p> | <p>"I have trodden the winepress alone, and from the peoples no one was with Me. I trod them in My anger and trampled them in My fury. Their lifeblood splattered on My garments, and I stained all My clothing.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For the day of vengeance is in mine heart, and the year of my redeemed is come.</i></p> | <p>For the day of vengeance was in My heart, and the year of My redeemed had come.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And I looked, and there was none to help; and I wondered that there was none to uphold: therefore mine own arm brought salvation unto me; and my fury, it upheld me.</i></p> | <p>I looked, but there was no one to help. I was appalled that there was no one to assist. So My own arm brought salvation, and My fury upheld Me.</p> |

- 6 *And I will tread down the people in mine anger, and make them drunk in my fury, and I will bring down their strength to the earth.* I trampled the peoples in My anger; I made them drunk in My fury. I poured out their lifeblood on the ground."
- 7 *I will mention the lovingkindnesses of the LORD, and the praises of the LORD, according to all that the LORD hath bestowed on us, and the great goodness toward the house of Israel, which he hath bestowed on them according to his mercies, and according to the multitude of his lovingkindnesses.* I will tell of the mercies of the LORD — the praiseworthy acts of the LORD — according to all that the LORD has done for us, the great goodness to the house of Israel which He has shown them according to His mercy, according to the abundance of His mercies.
- 8 *For he said, Surely they are my people, children that will not lie: so he was their Saviour.* For He said, "Surely they are My people — children who will not deal falsely." So He became their Savior.
- 9 *In all their affliction he was afflicted, and the angel of his presence saved them: in his love and in his pity he redeemed them; and he bare them, and carried them all the days of old.* In all their distress He too was distressed, and the angel of his presence saved them. In his love and in His mercy He redeemed them. He lifted them up and carried them all the days of old.
- 10 *But they rebelled, and vexed his holy Spirit: therefore he was turned to be their enemy, and he fought against them.* But they rebelled and grieved His Holy Spirit. So He turned to be their enemy; He Himself fought against them.
- 11 *Then he remembered the days of old, Moses, and his people, saying, Where is he that brought them up out of the sea with the shepherd of his flock? where is he that put his holy Spirit within him?* Then He remembered the days of old — of Moses and his people. Where is he who brought them up out of the sea with the shepherd of his flock? Where is He who put his Holy Spirit within him?

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| 12 <i>That led them by the right hand of Moses with his glorious arm, dividing the water before them, to make himself an everlasting name?</i> | Who led them by the right hand of Moses, with his glorious arm — dividing the waters before them — to make for Himself an everlasting name? |
| 13 <i>That led them through the deep, as an horse in the wilderness, that they should not stumble?</i> | Who led them through the deep as a horse through the wilderness, without stumbling? |
| 14 <i>As a beast goeth down into the valley, the Spirit of the LORD caused him to rest: so didst thou lead thy people, to make thyself a glorious name.</i> | Like cattle that go down into the valley, the Spirit of the LORD gave them rest. So You led Your people, to make for Yourself a glorious name. |
| 15 <i>Look down from heaven, and behold from the habitation of thy holiness and of thy glory: where is thy zeal and thy strength, the sounding of thy bowels and of thy mercies toward me? are they restrained?</i> | Look down from heaven and see — from Your holy and glorious dwelling. Where are Your zeal and Your might? The stirring of Your heart and Your mercies are withheld from me. |
| 16 <i>Doubtless thou art our father, though Abraham be ignorant of us, and Israel acknowledge us not: thou, O LORD, art our father, our redeemer; thy name is from everlasting.</i> | For You are our Father — though Abraham does not know us and Israel does not acknowledge us. You, O LORD, are our Father; our Redeemer from of old is Your name. |
| 17 <i>O LORD, why hast thou made us to err from thy ways, and hardened our heart from thy fear? Return for thy servants' sake, the tribes of thine inheritance.</i> | O LORD, why do You make us stray from Your ways and harden our heart from fearing You? Return for the sake of Your servants — the tribes of Your heritage. |
| 18 <i>The people of thy holiness have possessed it but a little while: our adversaries have trodden down thy sanctuary.</i> | Your holy people possessed it for a little while, but our adversaries have trampled down Your sanctuary. |
| 19 <i>We are thine: thou never barest rule over them; they were not called by thy name.</i> | We have become like those over whom You have never ruled, like those who are not called by Your name. |

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 19:13; Isa 34:5-6; Ps 137:7; Isa 63:2-3; Num 23:19
- v2 — Rev 19:13
- v3 — Rev 19:13-15; Rev 14:19-20; Mic 7:10; Mal 4:3; Zech 10:5
- v4 — Isa 34:8; Isa 35:4; Isa 61:2; Jer 51:6; Rev 18:20
- v5 — Ps 44:3
- v7 — Eph 2:4; Ps 86:5; Ps 86:15
- v9 — Ex 33:14; Ex 23:20-21; Mal 3:1; Acts 7:34-35; Acts 12:11
- v10 — Acts 7:51; Eph 4:30; Ps 78:56; Ps 78:40; Jer 21:5
- v11 — Num 11:17
- v15 — Deut 26:15; Jer 31:20; Ps 80:14; Hos 11:8; Ps 123:1
- v16 — Isa 64:8; Mal 2:10; Deut 32:6; Jer 3:19
- v17 — Isa 6:10; Josh 11:20; Ezek 14:7-9; Deut 2:30

Chapter 64

Isaiah pleads for the LORD to come down and make His name known to His adversaries. He confesses that all Israel's righteousnesses are as filthy rags, and they have all faded like a leaf. He asks the LORD not to be angry beyond measure and remembers that they are the clay and the LORD is the potter.

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| 1 | <i>Oh that thou wouldst rend the heavens, that thou wouldst come down, that the mountains might flow down at thy presence,</i> | Oh, that You would tear open the heavens and come down — that the mountains might quake at Your presence |
| 2 | <i>As when the melting fire burneth, the fire causeth the waters to boil, to make thy name known to thine adversaries, that the nations may tremble at thy presence!</i> | as fire kindles brushwood and fire causes water to boil — to make Your name known to Your adversaries, and that the nations may tremble at your presence! |
| 3 | <i>When thou didst terrible things which we looked not for, thou camest down, the mountains flowed down at thy presence.</i> | When You did awesome things we did not expect — You came down; the mountains quaked at Your presence. |

- 4 *For since the beginning of the world men have not heard, nor perceived by the ear, neither hath the eye seen, O God, beside thee, what he hath prepared for him that waiteth for him.* From of old no one has heard, no ear has perceived, no eye has seen any God besides You — who acts on behalf of those who wait for Him.
- 5 *Thou meetest him that rejoiceth and worketh righteousness, those that remember thee in thy ways: behold, thou art wroth; for we have sinned: in those is continuance, and we shall be saved.* You meet the one who rejoices in doing righteousness, those who remember You in Your ways. Look — You were angry, and we sinned. We have long continued in our sins, and shall we be saved?
- 6 *But we are all as an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as filthy rags; and we all do fade as a leaf; and our iniquities, like the wind, have taken us away.* We have all become like one who is unclean, and all our righteous deeds are like a filthy garment. We all wither like a leaf, and our iniquities carry us away like the wind.
- 7 *And there is none that calleth upon thy name, that stirreth up himself to take hold of thee: for thou hast hid thy face from us, and hast consumed us, because of our iniquities.* There is no one who calls on your name, who rouses himself to take hold of You. For You have hidden Your face from us and have consumed us because of our iniquities.
- 8 *But now, O LORD, thou art our father; we are the clay, and thou our potter; and we all are the work of thy hand.* But now, O LORD, You are our Father. We are the clay, and You are our potter. We are all the work of Your hand.
- 9 *Be not wroth very sore, O LORD, neither remember iniquity for ever: behold, see, we beseech thee, we are all thy people.* Do not be so angry, O LORD, and do not remember iniquity forever. Look — please look — we are all Your people!
- 10 *Thy holy cities are a wilderness, Zion is a wilderness, Jerusalem a desolation.* Your holy cities have become a wilderness; Zion has become a wilderness; Jerusalem a desolation.

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| <p>11 <i>Our holy and our beautiful house, where our fathers praised thee, is burned up with fire: and all our pleasant things are laid waste.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Wilt thou refrain thyself for these things, O LORD? wilt thou hold thy peace, and afflict us very sore?</i></p> | <p>Our holy and beautiful house — where our fathers praised You — has been burned by fire, and all our cherished things have been ruined.</p> <p>Will You restrain Yourself over these things, O LORD? Will You keep silent and punish us so severely?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Mic 1:3-4; Mark 1:10; Rev 20:11; Ex 19:18-19; Ps 68:8

v2 — Ps 99:1; Jer 33:9

v4 — 1 Cor 2:9-10; Ps 31:19; Jas 5:7; Isa 25:9; Col 1:26-27

v6 — Rom 7:18; Rom 7:24; Eph 2:1-2; Rev 3:17-18; Zech 3:3

v7 — Ezek 22:30; Isa 59:16; Hos 7:14; Isa 50:2

v8 — Eph 2:10; Ps 119:73; Jer 18:2-6; Ps 138:8; Ps 100:3

v10 — Isa 1:7

v11 — 2 Kgs 25:9; Ps 74:5-7; Lam 1:7; Lam 1:10-11; 2 Chr 36:19

v12 — Isa 42:14

Chapter 65

The LORD declares that He was found by those who did not seek Him and spread out His hands to a rebellious people. He will bring judgment on those who forsake Him but will preserve a remnant. He will create new heavens and a new earth, and the former things shall not be remembered. In the new Jerusalem there will be no more weeping, and the wolf and the lamb shall feed together.

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| <p>1 <i>I am sought of them that asked not for me; I am found of them that sought me not: I said, Behold me, behold me, unto a nation that was not called by my name.</i></p> | <p>I was found by those who did not seek Me; I revealed Myself to those who did not ask for Me. I said, "Here I am, here I am," to a nation that was not called by My name.</p> |
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| <p>2 <i>I have spread out my hands all the day unto a rebellious people, which walketh in a way that was not good, after their own thoughts;</i></p> | <p>All day long I have held out My hands to a rebellious people — who walk in a way that is not good, following their own thoughts,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>A people that provoketh me to anger continually to my face; that sacrificeth in gardens, and burneth incense upon altars of brick;</i></p> | <p>a people who provoke Me to My face continually — sacrificing in gardens and burning incense on bricks,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Which remain among the graves, and lodge in the monuments, which eat swine's flesh, and broth of abominable things is in their vessels;</i></p> | <p>who sit in tombs and spend the night in secret places, who eat pig's meat with broth of detestable things in their pots,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Which say, Stand by thyself, come not near to me; for I am holier than thou. These are a smoke in my nose, a fire that burneth all the day.</i></p> | <p>who say, "Keep to Yourself; do not come near me, for I am holier than You." These are smoke in My nostrils — a fire that burns all day.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Behold, it is written before me: I will not keep silence, but will recompense, even recompense into their bosom,</i></p> | <p>See, it is written before Me. I will not keep silent; I will repay. I will repay into their laps —</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Your iniquities, and the iniquities of your fathers together, saith the LORD, which have burned incense upon the mountains, and blasphemed me upon the hills: therefore will I measure their former work into their bosom.</i></p> | <p>both Your iniquities and the iniquities of Your fathers together, says the LORD. Because they burned incense on the mountains and dishonored Me on the hills, I will measure their past deeds into their laps.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Thus saith the LORD, As the new wine is found in the cluster, and one saith, Destroy it not; for a blessing is in it: so will I do for my servants' sake, that I may not destroy them all.</i></p> | <p>Thus says the LORD: "As new wine is found in the grape cluster and someone says, 'Do not destroy it, for there is a blessing in it,' so I will do for My servants' sake — I will not destroy them all.</p> |

- 9 *And I will bring forth a seed out of Jacob, and out of Judah an inheritor of my mountains: and mine elect shall inherit it, and my servants shall dwell there.* I will bring forth offspring from Jacob, and from Judah an heir of My mountains. My chosen shall inherit it, and My servants shall live there.
- 10 *And Sharon shall be a fold of flocks, and the valley of Achor a place for the herds to lie down in, for my people that have sought me.* Sharon shall become a pasture for flocks, and the Valley of Achor a resting place for herds, for My people who have sought Me.
- 11 *But ye are they that forsake the LORD, that forget my holy mountain, that prepare a table for that troop, and that furnish the drink offering unto that number.* But You who forsake the LORD — who forget My holy mountain, who set a table for Fortune and fill cups of mixed wine for Destiny —
- 12 *Therefore will I number you to the sword, and ye shall all bow down to the slaughter: because when I called, ye did not answer; when I spake, ye did not hear; but did evil before mine eyes, and did choose that wherein I delighted not.* I will destine You to the sword, and You shall all bow down to the slaughter. Because when I called You did not answer; when I spoke You did not listen. You did evil in My sight and chose what I did not delight in.
- 13 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, my servants shall eat, but ye shall be hungry: behold, my servants shall drink, but ye shall be thirsty: behold, my servants shall rejoice, but ye shall be ashamed:* Therefore thus says the Lord GOD: "My servants shall eat, but You shall be hungry. My servants shall drink, but You shall be thirsty. My servants shall rejoice, but You shall be put to shame.
- 14 *Behold, my servants shall sing for joy of heart, but ye shall cry for sorrow of heart, and shall howl for vexation of spirit.* My servants shall sing for joy of heart, but You shall cry out for pain of heart and shall wail for grief of spirit.
- 15 *And ye shall leave your name for a curse unto my chosen: for the Lord GOD shall slay thee, and call his servants by another name:* You shall leave Your name to My chosen as a curse, for the Lord GOD will put You to death and call His servants by another name.

- 16 *That he who blesseth himself in the earth shall bless himself in the God of truth; and he that sweareth in the earth shall swear by the God of truth; because the former troubles are forgotten, and because they are hid from mine eyes.* So that whoever blesses himself in the land shall bless himself by the God of truth, and whoever swears in the land shall swear by the God of truth. For the former troubles are forgotten; they are hidden from My eyes.
- 17 *For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth: and the former things shall not be remembered, nor come into mind.* For I create new heavens and a new earth. The former things shall not be remembered; they shall not come to mind.
- 18 *But be ye glad and rejoice for ever in that which I create: for, behold, I create Jerusalem a rejoicing, and her people a joy.* But be glad and rejoice forever in what I create. For I create Jerusalem as a joy and her people as a gladness.
- 19 *And I will rejoice in Jerusalem, and joy in my people: and the voice of weeping shall be no more heard in her, nor the voice of crying.* I will rejoice in Jerusalem and take delight in My people. The sound of weeping shall no more be heard in her, nor the cry of distress.
- 20 *There shall be no more thence an infant of days, nor an old man that hath not filled his days: for the child shall die an hundred years old; but the sinner being an hundred years old shall be accursed.* No more shall there be in it an infant who lives but a few days, or an old man who does not live out His years. The one who dies at a hundred years will be thought a youth, and the one who fails to reach a hundred shall be thought cursed.
- 21 *And they shall build houses, and inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, and eat the fruit of them.* They shall build houses and live in them; they shall plant vineyards and eat their fruit.
- 22 *They shall not build, and another inhabit; they shall not plant, and another eat: for as the days of a tree are the days of my people, and mine elect shall long enjoy the work of their hands.* They shall not build for another to live in; they shall not plant for another to eat. For like the days of a tree shall the days of My people be, and My chosen shall long enjoy the work of their hands.

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| <p>23 <i>They shall not labour in vain, nor bring forth for trouble; for they are the seed of the blessed of the LORD, and their offspring with them.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And it shall come to pass, that before they call, I will answer; and while they are yet speaking, I will hear.</i></p> <p>25 <i>The wolf and the lamb shall feed together, and the lion shall eat straw like the bullock: and dust shall be the serpent's meat. They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>They shall not labor in vain or bear children for calamity. For they shall be the offspring of the blessed of the LORD, and their descendants with them.</p> <p>Before they call I will answer; while they are still speaking, I will hear.</p> <p>The wolf and the lamb shall eat together; the lion shall eat straw like the ox. Dust shall be the serpent's food. They shall not hurt or destroy in all My holy mountain, says the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rom 10:20; Rom 9:24-26; 1 Pet 2:10; Eph 2:12-13; Hos 1:10
- v2** — Rom 10:21; Jer 4:14; Prov 1:24; Ps 81:11-12; Isa 1:2
- v6** — Ps 50:3; Jer 16:18; Ps 50:21; Ps 79:12
- v8** — Rom 9:27-29; Amos 9:8-9; Jer 30:11; Isa 6:13; Rom 11:5-6
- v13** — Mal 3:18; Isa 66:14; Luke 16:24-25; Isa 61:7
- v17** — 2 Pet 3:13; Rev 21:1-5; Isa 66:22; Isa 43:18; Jer 3:16
- v19** — Rev 21:4; Rev 7:17; Isa 25:8; Jer 32:41; Isa 35:10
- v20** — Job 5:26; Eccl 8:12-13; Deut 4:40; Ps 34:12; Rom 2:5-9
- v21** — Amos 9:14; Isa 62:8-9; Jer 31:4-5; Isa 32:18; Isa 37:30
- v22** — Ps 92:12-14; Ps 91:16; Ps 21:4; Isa 65:15
- v23** — Isa 61:9; Jer 32:38-39; Deut 28:3-12; Ps 115:14-15; Acts 2:39
- v24** — Dan 10:12; 1 John 5:14-15; Mark 11:24; Isa 58:9; Ps 91:15

Chapter 66

The LORD declares that heaven is His throne and the earth His footstool, and He looks to the one who is poor and of a contrite spirit and who trembles at His word. Zion shall bring forth her children in a day, and the LORD will comfort Jerusalem as a mother comforts her child. The LORD will come with fire and a whirlwind to judge all flesh, and the new heavens and the new earth shall remain before Him.

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| <p>1 <i>Thus saith the LORD, The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest?</i></p> | <p>Thus says the LORD: "Heaven is My throne and the earth is My footstool. What house would You build for Me? What place shall be My rest?</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For all those things hath mine hand made, and all those things have been, saith the LORD: but to this man will I look, even to him that is poor and of a contrite spirit, and trembleth at my word.</i></p> | <p>All these things My hand has made — all these things came to be, declares the LORD. But this is the one I will look to: He who is humble and contrite in spirit and trembles at My word.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>He that killeth an ox is as if he slew a man; he that sacrificeth a lamb, as if he cut off a dog's neck; he that offereth an oblation, as if he offered swine's blood; he that burneth incense, as if he blessed an idol. Yea, they have chosen their own ways, and their soul delighteth in their abominations.</i></p> | <p>He who slaughters an ox is like one who kills a man; he who sacrifices a lamb, like one who breaks a dog's neck; He who presents a grain offering, like one who offers pig's blood; He who burns frankincense, like one who blesses an idol. These have chosen their own ways, and their soul delights in their abominations.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>I also will choose their delusions, and will bring their fears upon them; because when I called, none did answer; when I spake, they did not hear: but they did evil before mine eyes, and chose that in which I delighted not.</i></p> | <p>I also will choose harsh treatment for them and bring their fears on them. Because when I called, no one answered; when I spoke, they did not listen. They did evil in My sight and chose what I did not delight in.</p> |

- 5 *Hear the word of the LORD, ye that tremble at his word; Your brethren that hated you, that cast you out for my name's sake, said, Let the LORD be glorified: but he shall appear to your joy, and they shall be ashamed.* Listen to the word of the LORD, You who tremble at His word. Your brothers who hate You and exclude You for My name's sake have said, "Let the LORD be glorified, so that we may see Your joy!" But they shall be put to shame.
- 6 *A voice of noise from the city, a voice from the temple, a voice of the LORD that rendereth recompence to his enemies.* A roaring sound from the city! A voice from the temple! The voice of the LORD — repaying His enemies what they deserve!
- 7 *Before she travailed, she brought forth; before her pain came, she was delivered of a man child.* Before she was in labor she gave birth. Before her pain came, she delivered a son.
- 8 *Who hath heard such a thing? who hath seen such things? Shall the earth be made to bring forth in one day? or shall a nation be born at once? for as soon as Zion travailed, she brought forth her children.* Who has heard such a thing? Who has seen such things? Shall a land be born in one day? Shall a nation be brought forth in a moment? For as soon as Zion was in labor, she gave birth to her children.
- 9 *Shall I bring to the birth, and not cause to bring forth? saith the LORD: shall I cause to bring forth, and shut the womb? saith thy God.* Shall I bring to the point of birth and not deliver? says the LORD. Shall I, who cause delivery, shut the womb? says Your God.
- 10 *Rejoice ye with Jerusalem, and be glad with her, all ye that love her: rejoice for joy with her, all ye that mourn for her:* Rejoice with Jerusalem; be glad for her, all You who love her. Rejoice with her for joy, all You who mourn over her —
- 11 *That ye may suck, and be satisfied with the breasts of her consolations; that ye may milk out, and be delighted with the abundance of her glory.* that You may nurse and be satisfied from her comforting breast; that You may drink deeply and delight yourselves in the abundance of her glory.

- 12 *For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will extend peace to her like a river, and the glory of the Gentiles like a flowing stream: then shall ye suck, ye shall be borne upon her sides, and be dandled upon her knees.* For thus says the LORD: "I will extend peace to her like a river and the wealth of the nations like an overflowing stream. You shall nurse; You shall be carried on her hip and bounced on her knees.
- 13 *As one whom his mother comforteth, so will I comfort you; and ye shall be comforted in Jerusalem.* As a mother comforts her child, so I will comfort You. You shall be comforted in Jerusalem."
- 14 *And when ye see this, your heart shall rejoice, and your bones shall flourish like an herb: and the hand of the LORD shall be known toward his servants, and his indignation toward his enemies.* When You see this, Your heart shall rejoice; Your bones shall flourish like the grass. The hand of the LORD shall be known to His servants, and his indignation to his enemies.
- 15 *For, behold, the LORD will come with fire, and with his chariots like a whirlwind, to render his anger with fury, and his rebuke with flames of fire.* For the LORD will come with fire — with his chariots like a whirlwind — to repay His anger with fury, and His rebuke with flames of fire.
- 16 *For by fire and by his sword will the LORD plead with all flesh: and the slain of the LORD shall be many.* For by fire and by his sword the LORD will judge all flesh, and those slain by the LORD shall be many.
- 17 *They that sanctify themselves, and purify themselves in the gardens behind one tree in the midst, eating swine's flesh, and the abomination, and the mouse, shall be consumed together, saith the LORD.* Those who sanctify and purify themselves to go into the gardens — following one in the midst — eating pig's meat and the detestable thing and mice, shall come to an end together, declares the LORD.
- 18 *For I know their works and their thoughts: it shall come, that I will gather all nations and tongues; and they shall come, and see my glory.* For I know their works and their thoughts. The time is coming to gather all nations and tongues. They shall come and shall see My glory.

- 19 *And I will set a sign among them, and I will send those that escape of them unto the nations, to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, that draw the bow, to Tubal, and Javan, to the isles afar off, that have not heard my fame, neither have seen my glory; and they shall declare my glory among the Gentiles.* I will set a sign among them. From those who escape I will send some to the nations — to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, who draw the bow; to Tubal and Javan, to the distant coastlands that have not heard My fame or seen My glory. They shall declare My glory among the nations.
- 20 *And they shall bring all your brethren for an offering unto the LORD out of all nations upon horses, and in chariots, and in litters, and upon mules, and upon swift beasts, to my holy mountain Jerusalem, saith the LORD, as the children of Israel bring an offering in a clean vessel into the house of the LORD.* They shall bring all Your brothers from all the nations as an offering to the LORD — on horses, in chariots and wagons, on mules and on swift camels — to My holy mountain Jerusalem, declares the LORD, just as the Israelites bring their grain offering in a clean vessel to the house of the LORD.
- 21 *And I will also take of them for priests and for Levites, saith the LORD.* And some of them also I will take for priests and for Levites, says the LORD.
- 22 *For as the new heavens and the new earth, which I will make, shall remain before me, saith the LORD, so shall your seed and your name remain.* For as the new heavens and the new earth that I make shall remain before Me, declares the LORD, so shall Your offspring and Your name remain.
- 23 *And it shall come to pass, that from one new moon to another, and from one sabbath to another, shall all flesh come to worship before me, saith the LORD.* From new moon to new moon, and from Sabbath to Sabbath, all flesh shall come to worship before Me, declares the LORD.
- 24 *And they shall go forth, and look upon the carcasses of the men that have transgressed against me: for their worm shall not die, neither shall their fire be quenched; and they shall be an abhorring unto all flesh.* They shall go out and look on the dead bodies of the men who have transgressed against Me. For their worm shall not die, and their fire shall not be quenched, and they shall be an abhorrence to all flesh.

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Acts 7:48-50; Acts 17:24; Matt 5:34-35; 1 Kgs 8:27; Ps 132:7

v2 — Isa 57:15; Ps 34:18; Ps 51:17; Matt 5:3-4; 2 Chr 34:27-28

v3 — Prov 15:8; Isa 1:11-15; Amos 5:21-22; Isa 65:12; Isa 66:17

v5 — John 15:18-20; Matt 5:10-12; Isa 66:2; Matt 10:22; Ps 38:20

v12 — Isa 60:16; Isa 48:18; Isa 45:14; Isa 66:11; Isa 49:19-23

v13 — 2 Cor 1:4; Isa 51:3; Isa 40:1; 1 Thess 2:7; Isa 66:10

v15 — Isa 30:33; 2 Pet 3:10-12; 2 Thess 1:6-9; Matt 22:7; Ps 97:3

v17 — Isa 65:3-4; Deut 14:3-8; Lev 11:2-8; Isa 1:28-29

v19 — Isa 52:15; Rom 15:21; Isa 55:5; Ezek 27:10; Isa 60:9

v22 — Isa 65:17; Rev 21:1; 2 Pet 3:13; John 10:27-29; 1 Pet 1:4-5

v23 — Ezek 46:1; Ps 86:9; Ezek 46:6; Zech 14:16; Col 2:16-17

v24 — Isa 14:11; Rev 14:10-11; Dan 12:2; 1 Thess 2:15-16; Rev 21:8

Jeremiah

Author: Jeremiah the priest, with Baruch son of Neriah as his scribe — the book records Baruch writing the prophecies Jeremiah dictated (Jer 36:4) and Jeremiah's own purchase of land as a sign-act of hope (ch. 32).

Date written: c. 627–580 BC, spanning the final decades of Judah's existence through the destruction of Jerusalem and its aftermath.

Written to: The people of Judah — those remaining in the land, those already exiled to Babylon, and those who fled to Egypt.

Setting: Judah's final forty years. The Babylonian empire is rising. Five kings come and go. Jeremiah preaches a deeply unpopular message — surrender to Babylon, because this judgment is from God — and suffers imprisonment, beatings, and near-execution for it.

Where this sits historically: Written under Josiah, Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, and Zedekiah (c. 627–580 BC), as Assyria collapsed (Nineveh fell 612 BC) and Nebuchadnezzar's Babylon rose to destroy Jerusalem in 586 BC.

Contemporaries: Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Nahum, and Obadiah all prophesied in this window, while Daniel and Ezekiel were carried captive to Babylon during Jeremiah's own lifetime.

Big themes:

- The reluctant prophet — Jeremiah protests his call, weeps over the people's sin, and is called "the weeping prophet"; he is the most personally revealed prophet in the OT
- Judgment inevitable — Jeremiah preaches for forty years that Jerusalem will fall; he is ignored, mocked, and imprisoned; the city falls exactly as he said
- The new covenant — Jeremiah 31:31–34 contains the OT's clearest promise of a new covenant written on the heart, quoted extensively in Hebrews 8
- The potter and the clay — God's sovereignty over nations is absolute; He shapes and reshapes according to His purposes
- Lament — the book contains more complaint psalms and personal anguish than any other prophetic book; faith does not eliminate suffering

Key passages: Jer 1:5; 17:9; 29:11; 31:31–34; 33:3

How it fits: Jeremiah prophesied during the events 2 Kings 22–25 records. He was the prophet whose seventy-year exile prediction Daniel read in Babylon (Dan 9:2). The new covenant he announced in chapter 31 becomes the foundation of everything the NT says about salvation and the church (Heb 8:6–13).

Chapter 1

The LORD called Jeremiah before he was born and ordained him a prophet to the nations. Jeremiah protested that he was only a child, but the LORD touched his mouth and put His words in it. The LORD showed him two visions -- an almond branch and a boiling pot tilting from the north -- and promised to make him a fortified city against the whole land.

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| 1 | <i>The words of Jeremiah the son of Hilkiah, of the priests that were in Anathoth in the land of Benjamin:</i> | These are the words of Jeremiah son of Hilkiah, one of the priests who lived in Anathoth in the land of Benjamin. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jeremiah** (jair-uh-MY-uh) — "the LORD exalts" or "the LORD throws down" — a priest from Anathoth called by God to be a prophet to Judah and the nations. He ministered from the reign of Josiah through the fall of Jerusalem.

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| 2 | <i>To whom the word of the LORD came in the days of Josiah the son of Amon king of Judah, in the thirteenth year of his reign.</i> | The word of the LORD came to Him in the days of Josiah son of Amon, king of Judah, in the thirteenth year of His reign. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Josiah** (joe-SY-uh) — "the LORD supports" — the righteous king of Judah who led a great religious reform. He reigned from approximately 640–609 BC.

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| 3 | <i>It came also in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, unto the end of the eleventh year of Zedekiah the son of Josiah king of Judah, unto the carrying away of Jerusalem captive in the fifth month.</i> | It also came in the days of Jehoiakim son of Josiah, king of Judah, and continued through the end of the eleventh year of Zedekiah son of Josiah, king of Judah — until Jerusalem was carried into captivity in the fifth month. |
| 4 | <i>Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying: |
| 5 | <i>Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee; and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, and I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations.</i> | "Before I formed You in the womb I knew You. Before You were born I sanctified You and ordained You a prophet to the nations." |
| 6 | <i>Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! behold, I cannot speak: for I am a child.</i> | I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! I do not know how to speak — I am only a child." |

- 7 *But the LORD said unto me, Say not, I am a child: for thou shalt go to all that I shall send thee, and whatsoever I command thee thou shalt speak.* But the LORD said to me, "Do not say, 'I am only a child.' You will go to everyone I send You to, and You will speak everything I command You.
- 8 *Be not afraid of their faces: for I am with thee to deliver thee, saith the LORD.* Do not be afraid of them, for I am with You to rescue You," says the LORD.
- 9 *Then the LORD put forth his hand, and touched my mouth. And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have put my words in thy mouth.* Then the LORD reached out His hand and touched my mouth. He said to me, "I have put My words in Your mouth.
- 10 *See, I have this day set thee over the nations and over the kingdoms, to root out, and to pull down, and to destroy, and to throw down, to build, and to plant.* See — today I appoint You over nations and kingdoms, to uproot and tear down, to destroy and overthrow, to build and to plant."
- 11 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying, Jeremiah, what seest thou? And I said, I see a rod of an almond tree.* The word of the LORD came to me again: "Jeremiah, what do you see?" I said, "I see a branch of an almond tree."
- 12 *Then said the LORD unto me, Thou hast well seen: for I will hasten my word to perform it.* The LORD said, "You have seen correctly, for I am watching over My word to carry it out."
- 13 *And the word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying, What seest thou? And I said, I see a seething pot; and the face thereof is toward the north.* The word of the LORD came to me a second time: "What do You see?" I said, "I see a boiling pot, tilting away from the north."
- 14 *Then the LORD said unto me, Out of the north an evil shall break forth upon all the inhabitants of the land.* The LORD said to me, "Disaster will break out from the north on all who live in this land.

- 15 *For, lo, I will call all the families of the kingdoms of the north, saith the LORD; and they shall come, and they shall set every one his throne at the entering of the gates of Jerusalem, and against all the walls thereof round about, and against all the cities of Judah.* For I am calling all the kingdoms of the north," says the LORD. "They will come and each king will set His throne at the entrance of Jerusalem's gates. They will attack all its surrounding walls and all the towns of Judah.
- 16 *And I will utter my judgments against them touching all their wickedness, who have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, and worshipped the works of their own hands.* I will pronounce judgment on them for all their wickedness. They have forsaken Me, burned incense to other gods, and worshiped the work of their own hands.
- 17 *Thou therefore gird up thy loins, and arise, and speak unto them all that I command thee: be not dismayed at their faces, lest I confound thee before them.* So prepare Yourself. Stand up and speak to them everything I command You. Do not be terrified by them, or I will terrify You before them.
- 18 *For, behold, I have made thee this day a defenced city, and an iron pillar, and brasen walls against the whole land, against the kings of Judah, against the princes thereof, against the priests thereof, and against the people of the land.* Today I have made You a fortified city, an iron pillar, and bronze walls against the whole land — against the kings of Judah, its officials, its priests, and the people of the land.
- 19 *And they shall fight against thee; but they shall not prevail against thee; for I am with thee, saith the LORD, to deliver thee.* They will fight against You but will not overcome You, for I am with You to rescue You," says the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

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| 3 | <i>Israel was holiness unto the LORD, and the firstfruits of his increase: all that devour him shall offend; evil shall come upon them, saith the LORD.</i> | Israel was holy to the LORD, the firstfruits of his harvest. All who devoured Israel were held guilty, and disaster came on them," says the LORD. |
| 4 | <i>Hear ye the word of the LORD, O house of Jacob, and all the families of the house of Israel:</i> | Hear the word of the LORD, You house of Jacob — all you families of Israel. |
| 5 | <i>Thus saith the LORD, What iniquity have your fathers found in me, that they are gone far from me, and have walked after vanity, and are become vain?</i> | This is what the LORD says: "What fault did Your ancestors find in Me, that they strayed so far? They followed worthless idols and became worthless themselves. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (in-IK-wih-tee) — "deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than 'sin' — it points to the corruption that lies beneath the sinful act itself."

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| 6 | <i>Neither said they, Where is the LORD that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, that led us through the wilderness, through a land of deserts and of pits, through a land of drought, and of the shadow of death, through a land that no man passed through, and where no man dwelt?</i> | They did not ask, 'Where is the LORD Who brought us up from Egypt? He led us through the desert, through a land of dry wasteland and deep darkness, through a land no one travels and no one lives in.' |
| 7 | <i>And I brought you into a plentiful country, to eat the fruit thereof and the goodness thereof; but when ye entered, ye defiled my land, and made mine heritage an abomination.</i> | I brought You into a fertile land to enjoy its fruit and good things. But when You entered, You defiled My land and made My inheritance detestable. |
| 8 | <i>The priests said not, Where is the LORD? and they that handle the law knew me not: the pastors also transgressed against me, and the prophets prophesied by Baal, and walked after things that do not profit.</i> | The priests did not ask, 'Where is the LORD?' Those who handled the law did not know Me. The leaders rebelled against Me. The prophets prophesied by Baal and followed useless things. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — "crossing the line God set; deliberately breaking a specific command He gave."

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| <p>9 <i>Wherefore I will yet plead with you, saith the LORD, and with your children's children will I plead.</i></p> | <p>"Therefore I will bring charges against You," says the LORD. "I will bring charges against Your grandchildren too.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>For pass over the isles of Chittim, and see; and send unto Kedar, and consider diligently, and see if there be such a thing:</i></p> | <p>Cross over to the coasts of Cyprus and look. Send to Kedar and observe closely. See if anything like this has happened:</p> |
| <p>11 <i>Hath a nation changed their gods, which are yet no gods? but my people have changed their glory for that which doth not profit.</i></p> | <p>Has any nation ever changed its gods — even though they are not real gods at all? Yet My people have exchanged their Glory for something that has no value.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Be astonished, O ye heavens, at this, and be horribly afraid, be ye very desolate, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Be shocked at this, You heavens! Shudder with great horror," says the LORD.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>For my people have committed two evils; they have forsaken me the fountain of living waters, and hewed them out cisterns, broken cisterns, that can hold no water.</i></p> | <p>"My people have committed two sins: They have abandoned Me, the spring of living water, and have dug their own cisterns — broken cisterns that hold no water.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Is Israel a servant? is he a homeborn slave? why is he spoiled?</i></p> | <p>Is Israel a slave? Was He born into slavery? Why then has He become plunder?</p> |
| <p>15 <i>The young lions roared upon him, and yelled, and they made his land waste: his cities are burned without inhabitant.</i></p> | <p>Lions have roared at Him and raised their voices. They have ruined His land. His cities are burned down with no one living in them.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>Also the children of Noph and Tahapanes have fed on the crown of thy head.</i></p> | <p>Also the men of Memphis and Tahpanhes have shaved the crown of Your head.</p> |

- 17 *Hast thou not procured this unto thyself, in that thou hast forsaken the LORD thy God, when he led thee by the way?* Have You not brought this on Yourself by forsaking the LORD Your God when He led You in the way?
- 18 *And now what hast thou to do in the way of Egypt, to drink the waters of Sihor? or what hast thou to do in the way of Assyria, to drink the waters of the river?* Now why go to Egypt to drink the waters of the Nile? And why go to Assyria to drink water from the Euphrates?
- 19 *Thine own wickedness shall correct thee, and thy backslidings shall reprove thee: know therefore and see that it is an evil thing and bitter, that thou hast forsaken the LORD thy God, and that my fear is not in thee, saith the Lord GOD of hosts.* Your own wickedness will punish You. Your unfaithfulness will correct You. Know and see how evil and bitter it is to forsake the LORD Your God and to have no fear of Me," says the Lord GOD of hosts.
- 20 *For of old time I have broken thy yoke, and burst thy bands; and thou saidst, I will not transgress; when upon every high hill and under every green tree thou wanderest, playing the harlot.* "Long ago I broke Your yoke and tore off Your chains. You said, 'I will not serve idols.' Yet on every high hill and under every green tree You lay down and played the harlot.
- 21 *Yet I had planted thee a noble vine, wholly a right seed: how then art thou turned into the degenerate plant of a strange vine unto me?* I planted You as a choice vine — all good stock. How then have You turned into a corrupt, wild vine?
- 22 *For though thou wash thee with nitre, and take thee much soap, yet thine iniquity is marked before me, saith the Lord GOD.* Even if You scrub Yourself with lye and use plenty of soap, the stain of Your iniquity is still before Me," says the Lord GOD.
- 23 *How canst thou say, I am not polluted, I have not gone after Baalim? see thy way in the valley, know what thou hast done: thou art a swift dromedary traversing her ways;* How can You say, 'I am not defiled — I have not followed the Baals'? Look at what You did in the valley. Know what You have done. You are a swift young camel running back and forth,

- 24 *A wild ass used to the wilderness, that snuffeth up the wind at her pleasure; in her occasion who can turn her away? all they that seek her will not weary themselves; in her month they shall find her.* a wild donkey at home in the desert, sniffing the wind in her craving. Who can hold her back when she is in heat? Any male that seeks her will find her easily in her season.
- 25 *Withhold thy foot from being unshod, and thy throat from thirst: but thou saidst, There is no hope: no; for I have loved strangers, and after them will I go.* Keep Your feet from going bare and Your throat from thirst. But You said, 'It is no use! I love foreign gods and must go after them.'
- 26 *As the thief is ashamed when he is found, so is the house of Israel ashamed; they, their kings, their princes, and their priests, and their prophets,* As a thief is shamed when caught, so the house of Israel is shamed — their kings, their officials, their priests, and their prophets.
- 27 *Saying to a stock, Thou art my father; and to a stone, Thou hast brought me forth: for they have turned their back unto me, and not their face: but in the time of their trouble they will say, Arise, and save us.* They say to wood, 'You are my father,' and to stone, 'You gave birth to me.' They have turned their backs to Me and not their face. Yet when they are in trouble, they say, 'Come and save us.'
- 28 *But where are thy gods that thou hast made thee? let them arise, if they can save thee in the time of thy trouble: for according to the number of thy cities are thy gods, O Judah.* Where then are the gods You made for Yourself? Let them come if they can save You when You are in trouble. For You have as many gods as You have cities, O Judah.
- 29 *Wherefore will ye plead with me? ye all have transgressed against me, saith the LORD.* Why do You bring charges against Me? You have all rebelled against Me," says the LORD.
- 30 *In vain have I smitten your children; they received no correction: your own sword hath devoured your prophets, like a destroying lion.* I struck Your people in vain — they accepted no correction. Your sword has devoured Your prophets like a destroying lion.

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| <p>31 <i>O generation, see ye the word of the LORD. Have I been a wilderness unto Israel? a land of darkness? wherefore say my people, We are lords; we will come no more unto thee?</i></p> <p>32 <i>Can a maid forget her ornaments, or a bride her attire? yet my people have forgotten me days without number.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Why trimmest thou thy way to seek love? therefore hast thou also taught the wicked ones thy ways.</i></p> <p>34 <i>Also in thy skirts is found the blood of the souls of the poor innocents: I have not found it by secret search, but upon all these.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Yet thou sayest, Because I am innocent, surely his anger shall turn from him. Behold, I will plead with thee, because thou sayest, I have not sinned.</i></p> <p>36 <i>Why gaddest thou about so much to change thy way? thou also shalt be ashamed of Egypt, as thou wast ashamed of Assyria.</i></p> <p>37 <i>Yea, thou shalt go forth from him, and thine hands upon thine head: for the LORD hath rejected thy confidences, and thou shalt not prosper in them.</i></p> | <p>You of this generation, listen to the word of the LORD. Have I been a desert to Israel? A land of deep darkness? Why do My people say, 'We are free to roam — we will come to You no more'?</p> <p>Does a young woman forget her jewelry? Does a bride forget her wedding clothes? Yet My people have forgotten Me for more days than can be counted.</p> <p>How skilled you are at chasing love! You have even taught the wicked women your ways.</p> <p>On your clothes is found the blood of the innocent poor. You did not catch them breaking in — yet in spite of all this</p> <p>you say, 'I am innocent. Surely His anger has turned away from me.' But I will judge you because you say, 'I have not sinned.'</p> <p>Why do you run here and there, changing your alliances? You will be disappointed by Egypt just as you were disappointed by Assyria.</p> <p>You will leave that place with Your hands on Your head, for the LORD has rejected those You trust. You will not succeed with their help.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ezek 16:60; Ezek 16:8; Jer 11:6; Deut 8:2; Deut 2:7
- v3 — Jas 1:18; Rev 14:4; Deut 7:6; Rom 11:16; Isa 41:11
- v5 — 2 Kgs 17:15; Rom 1:21; Jonah 2:8; Ps 115:8; Jer 10:14-15
- v7 — Deut 8:7-9; Jer 16:18; Num 13:27
- v11 — Rom 1:23; Isa 37:19; Ps 106:20; Jer 16:20; Mic 4:5
- v13 — John 4:14; John 7:37; Rev 21:6; Jer 17:13; Ps 36:9
- v17 — Jer 4:18; Jer 2:19; Jer 2:13
- v19 — Isa 3:9; Jer 4:18; Jer 2:17; Ps 36:1; Hos 5:5
- v21 — Isa 5:4; John 15:1; Ex 15:17; Ps 44:2; Ps 80:8
- v22 — Jer 17:1; Job 14:17; Hos 13:12
- v28 — Jer 11:13; Deut 32:37; Judg 10:14; Isa 45:20
- v32 — Ps 106:21; Jer 13:25; Jer 2:11; Jer 3:21

Chapter 3

The LORD compared Israel to a wife who has played the harlot with many lovers and yet asks to return. He called faithless Israel and treacherous Judah to repent, promising to give them shepherds after His own heart. He declared that in those days they will no longer speak of the ark of the covenant, for Jerusalem itself will be called the throne of the LORD.

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| <p>¹ <i>They say, If a man put away his wife, and she go from him, and become another man's, shall he return unto her again? shall not that land be greatly polluted? but thou hast played the harlot with many lovers; yet return again to me, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>God says: "If a man divorces his wife and she leaves him and marries another man, can He take her back? Would not that land be completely defiled? But You have committed adultery with many partners — yet return to Me," says the LORD.</p> |
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- 2 *Lift up thine eyes unto the high places, and see where thou hast not been lain with. In the ways hast thou sat for them, as the Arabian in the wilderness; and thou hast polluted the land with thy whoredoms and with thy wickedness.* Look up at the bare heights and see: where have You not been lain with? You sat by the roadside waiting for lovers, like an Arabian in the wilderness. You have polluted the land with Your whoredoms and with Your wickedness.
- 3 *Therefore the showers have been withholden, and there hath been no latter rain; and thou hadst a whore's forehead, thou refusedst to be ashamed.* Therefore the spring rains have been withheld and the late rains have not come. Yet You have a whore's forehead — you refuse to be ashamed.
- 4 *Wilt thou not from this time cry unto me, My father, thou art the guide of my youth?* Have You not just now called to Me, 'My Father, You are the friend of my youth'?
- 5 *Will he reserve his anger for ever? will he keep it to the end? Behold, thou hast spoken and done evil things as thou couldst.* 'Will God be angry forever? Will He be angry to the end?' You say this, but You keep on doing evil."
- 6 *The LORD said also unto me in the days of Josiah the king, Hast thou seen that which backsliding Israel hath done? she is gone up upon every high mountain and under every green tree, and there hath played the harlot.* In the days of King Josiah the LORD said to me: "Have You seen what backsliding Israel has done? She has gone up on every high mountain and under every green tree and played the harlot there.
- 7 *And I said after she had done all these things, Turn thou unto me. But she returned not. And her treacherous sister Judah saw it.* After she had done all this, I said to her, 'Return to Me.' But she did not return. Her unfaithful sister Judah saw this.
- 8 *And I saw, when for all the causes whereby backsliding Israel committed adultery I had put her away, and given her a bill of divorce; yet her treacherous sister Judah feared not, but went and played the harlot also.* I saw that because backsliding Israel had committed adultery, I had put her away and given her a bill of divorce. Yet her treacherous sister Judah had no fear — she also went and played the harlot.

- 9 *And it came to pass through the lightness of her whoredom, that she defiled the land, and committed adultery with stones and with stocks.* Through the lightness of her whoredom she defiled the land and committed adultery with stones and with stocks.
- 10 *And yet for all this her treacherous sister Judah hath not turned unto me with her whole heart, but feignedly, saith the LORD.* Even after all this, her unfaithful sister Judah has not returned to Me with her whole heart — only in pretense," says the LORD.
- 11 *And the LORD said unto me, The backsliding Israel hath justified herself more than treacherous Judah.* The LORD said to me, "Faithless Israel is more righteous than unfaithful Judah.
- 12 *Go and proclaim these words toward the north, and say, Return, thou backsliding Israel, saith the LORD; and I will not cause mine anger to fall upon you: for I am merciful, saith the LORD, and I will not keep anger for ever.* Go, proclaim this message toward the north: 'Return, faithless Israel,' says the LORD. 'I will not look on You in anger, for I am merciful,' says the LORD. 'I will not be angry forever.
- 13 *Only acknowledge thine iniquity, that thou hast transgressed against the LORD thy God, and hast scattered thy ways to the strangers under every green tree, and ye have not obeyed my voice, saith the LORD.* Only acknowledge Your iniquity — that You have rebelled against the LORD Your God and scattered Your favors among foreign gods under every green tree, and that You have not obeyed Me," says the LORD.
- 14 *Turn, O backsliding children, saith the LORD; for I am married unto you: and I will take you one of a city, and two of a family, and I will bring you to Zion:* "Return, faithless children," says the LORD, "for I am Your master. I will take You — one from a city, two from a family — and bring You to Zion.
- 15 *And I will give you pastors according to mine heart, which shall feed you with knowledge and understanding.* Then I will give You shepherds after My own heart, who will lead You with knowledge and understanding.

- 16 *And it shall come to pass, when ye be multiplied and increased in the land, in those days, saith the LORD, they shall say no more, The ark of the covenant of the LORD: neither shall it come to mind: neither shall they remember it; neither shall they visit it; neither shall that be done any more.*
- In those days, when You have multiplied and grown in the land," says the LORD, "people will no longer say, 'The ark of the covenant of the LORD.' It will not come to mind or be remembered or missed. It will not be made again.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — "a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people."

- 17 *At that time they shall call Jerusalem the throne of the LORD; and all the nations shall be gathered unto it, to the name of the LORD, to Jerusalem: neither shall they walk any more after the imagination of their evil heart.*
- At that time Jerusalem will be called the throne of the LORD. All nations will gather there in the name of the LORD. They will no longer follow the stubbornness of their evil hearts.
- 18 *In those days the house of Judah shall walk with the house of Israel, and they shall come together out of the land of the north to the land that I have given for an inheritance unto your fathers.*
- In those days Judah and Israel will come together from the land of the north to the land I gave Your ancestors as an inheritance.
- 19 *But I said, How shall I put thee among the children, and give thee a pleasant land, a goodly heritage of the hosts of nations? and I said, Thou shalt call me, My father; and shalt not turn away from me.*
- I said, 'How gladly would I treat You like a son and give You a pleasant land — the most beautiful inheritance of any nation.' I thought You would call Me 'My Father' and never turn away from Me.
- 20 *Surely as a wife treacherously departeth from her husband, so have ye dealt treacherously with me, O house of Israel, saith the LORD.*
- But like a woman who is unfaithful to her husband, you have been unfaithful to Me, Israel," says the LORD.

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| <p>21 <i>A voice was heard upon the high places, weeping and supplications of the children of Israel: for they have perverted their way, and they have forgotten the LORD their God.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Return, ye backsliding children, and I will heal your backslidings. Behold, we come unto thee; for thou art the LORD our God.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Truly in vain is salvation hoped for from the hills, and from the multitude of mountains: truly in the LORD our God is the salvation of Israel.</i></p> <p>24 <i>For shame hath devoured the labour of our fathers from our youth; their flocks and their herds, their sons and their daughters.</i></p> <p>25 <i>We lie down in our shame, and our confusion covereth us: for we have sinned against the LORD our God, we and our fathers, from our youth even unto this day, and have not obeyed the voice of the LORD our God.</i></p> | <p>A sound is heard on the bare heights — the weeping and pleading of the children of Israel, because they have twisted their way and forgotten the LORD their God.</p> <p>"Return, faithless children — I will heal Your unfaithfulness." "We come to You, for You are the LORD our God.</p> <p>Truly the noise from the hills is a deception. Truly the LORD our God is the salvation of Israel.</p> <p>From our youth the shameful idol has consumed what our fathers worked for — their flocks and herds, their sons and daughters.</p> <p>Let us lie down in our shame and let our dishonor cover us. We have sinned against the LORD our God — we and our ancestors — from our youth until now. We have not obeyed the LORD our God."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Deut 24:1-4; Ezek 16:26

v3 — Lev 26:19; Jer 5:24; Jer 14:4; Isa 5:6; Amos 4:7

v4 — Jer 2:2; Jer 3:19

- v12** — Ps 86:15; Ezek 33:11; Deut 4:29-31; Jer 3:22; Hos 14:1-3
v14 — Hos 2:19-20; Jer 2:19; Jer 31:32; Isa 54:5; Jer 31:8-10
v15 — Jer 23:4; Acts 20:28; Eph 4:11-12; Ezek 34:23; John 21:15-17
v16 — Amos 9:14-15; Isa 65:17; Ezek 37:26
v17 — Ezek 43:7; Mic 4:1-5; Jer 17:12; Zech 8:20-23; Jer 11:8
v18 — Jer 31:8; Amos 9:15; Hos 1:11; Jer 50:4; Jer 23:8
v19 — Rom 8:15-17; Jer 3:4; Jer 31:9; Isa 63:16
v22 — Hos 14:1; Hos 14:4; Zech 13:9; Hos 6:1-2; Jer 30:17
v23 — Ps 121:1-2; Ps 3:8

Chapter 4

The LORD called Israel to return and plow up fallow ground, and to circumcise their hearts. Jeremiah saw a vision of the coming destruction from the north -- the whole land laid waste, the cities broken down, and the heavens without light. The LORD declared that the whole land would be desolate, though He would not make a full end.

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| 1 | <i>If thou wilt return, O Israel, saith the LORD, return unto me: and if thou wilt put away thine abominations out of my sight, then shalt thou not remove.</i> | "If You return, Israel," says the LORD, "then return to Me. If You remove Your detestable idols from My sight, You will not wander away. |
| 2 | <i>And thou shalt swear, The LORD liveth, in truth, in judgment, and in righteousness; and the nations shall bless themselves in him, and in him shall they glory.</i> | You will swear, 'As the LORD lives' — in truth, in justice, and in righteousness. Then the nations will praise themselves by him, and in him they will boast." |
| 3 | <i>For thus saith the LORD to the men of Judah and Jerusalem, Break up your fallow ground, and sow not among thorns.</i> | This is what the LORD says to the people of Judah and Jerusalem: "Break up your unplowed ground and do not sow among thorns. |
| 4 | <i>Circumcise yourselves to the LORD, and take away the foreskins of your heart, ye men of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem: lest my fury come forth like fire, and burn that none can quench it, because of the evil of your doings.</i> | Circumcise yourselves to the LORD and remove the hardness of Your hearts, You people of Judah and Jerusalem. Otherwise My anger will break out like fire and burn with no one to put it out — because of your evil deeds." |

- 5 *Declare ye in Judah, and publish in Jerusalem; and say, Blow ye the trumpet in the land: cry, gather together, and say, Assemble yourselves, and let us go into the defended cities.* "Announce in Judah and proclaim in Jerusalem. Sound the trumpet throughout the land and cry out — gather together and say, 'Run to the fortified cities!'
- 6 *Set up the standard toward Zion: retire, stay not: for I will bring evil from the north, and a great destruction.* Raise the signal flag toward Zion. Flee for safety — do not delay! For I am bringing disaster from the north, a great destruction.
- 7 *The lion is come up from his thicket, and the destroyer of the Gentiles is on his way; he is gone forth from his place to make thy land desolate; and thy cities shall be laid waste, without an inhabitant.* A lion has come out of His den, a destroyer of nations has set out. He has left His place to lay Your land waste. Your cities will be ruined, left without a single inhabitant.
- 8 *For this gird you with sackcloth, lament and howl: for the fierce anger of the LORD is not turned back from us.* Because of this, put on sackcloth and mourn and wail, for the fierce anger of the LORD has not turned away from us.
- 9 *And it shall come to pass at that day, saith the LORD, that the heart of the king shall perish, and the heart of the princes; and the priests shall be astonished, and the prophets shall wonder.* "On that day," says the LORD, "the king and the officials will lose heart. The priests will be horrified and the prophets will be stunned."
- 10 *Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! surely thou hast greatly deceived this people and Jerusalem, saying, Ye shall have peace; whereas the sword reacheth unto the soul.* Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! You have truly deceived this people and Jerusalem by saying, 'You will have peace,' when the sword is at our throats!"

- 11 *At that time shall it be said to this people and to Jerusalem, A dry wind of the high places in the wilderness toward the daughter of my people, not to fan, nor to cleanse,* At that time this people and Jerusalem will be told: "A scorching wind from the barren heights in the desert blows toward My people — not to winnow or cleanse,
- 12 *Even a full wind from those places shall come unto me: now also will I give sentence against them.* but a full blast from those places. Now I will pronounce judgment against them."
- 13 *Behold, he shall come up as clouds, and his chariots shall be as a whirlwind: his horses are swifter than eagles. Woe unto us! for we are spoiled.* He comes up like clouds. his chariots are like a whirlwind. his horses are swifter than eagles. How terrible for us — we are ruined!
- 14 *O Jerusalem, wash thine heart from wickedness, that thou mayest be saved. How long shall thy vain thoughts lodge within thee?* Jerusalem, wash the evil from Your heart so You may be saved. How long will You harbor wicked thoughts?
- 15 *For a voice declareth from Dan, and publisheth affliction from mount Ephraim.* A voice announces from Dan — disaster proclaimed from the hills of Ephraim.
- 16 *Make ye mention to the nations; behold, publish against Jerusalem, that watchers come from a far country, and give out their voice against the cities of Judah.* "Warn the nations. Announce to Jerusalem: 'A besieging army is coming from a distant country, raising their voices against the cities of Judah.'
- 17 *As keepers of a field, are they against her round about; because she hath been rebellious against me, saith the LORD.* Like guards surrounding a field they close in on her on every side, because she has rebelled against Me," says the LORD.
- 18 *Thy way and thy doings have procured these things unto thee; this is thy wickedness, because it is bitter, because it reacheth unto thine heart.* Your own conduct and actions have brought this on You. This is Your punishment — how bitter it is! How it pierces to the heart!

- 19 *My bowels, my bowels! I am pained at my very heart; my heart maketh a noise in me; I cannot hold my peace, because thou hast heard, O my soul, the sound of the trumpet, the alarm of war.* My anguish! My anguish! I writhe in pain. My heart is pounding. I cannot be silent, for I have heard the sound of the trumpet — the alarm of war.
- 20 *Destruction upon destruction is cried; for the whole land is spoiled: suddenly are my tents spoiled, and my curtains in a moment.* Disaster after disaster is proclaimed. The whole land is ruined. Suddenly my tents are destroyed, my shelters in an instant.
- 21 *How long shall I see the standard, and hear the sound of the trumpet?* How long must I see the battle flag and hear the sound of the trumpet?
- 22 *For my people is foolish, they have not known me; they are sottish children, and they have none understanding: they are wise to do evil, but to do good they have no knowledge.* "My people are foolish. They do not know Me. They are senseless children with no understanding. They are skilled at doing evil but do not know how to do good."
- 23 *I beheld the earth, and, lo, it was without form, and void; and the heavens, and they had no light.* I looked at the earth — it was empty and formless. I looked at the sky — it had no light.
- 24 *I beheld the mountains, and, lo, they trembled, and all the hills moved lightly.* I looked at the mountains — they were shaking. All the hills were swaying.
- 25 *I beheld, and, lo, there was no man, and all the birds of the heavens were fled.* I looked — there was no one. Every bird in the sky had flown away.
- 26 *I beheld, and, lo, the fruitful place was a wilderness, and all the cities thereof were broken down at the presence of the LORD, and by his fierce anger.* I looked — the fertile land was a desert. Every city was in ruins before the LORD, before His fierce anger.

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| <p>27 <i>For thus hath the LORD said, The whole land shall be desolate; yet will I not make a full end.</i></p> <p>28 <i>For this shall the earth mourn, and the heavens above be black: because I have spoken it, I have purposed it, and will not repent, neither will I turn back from it.</i></p> <p>29 <i>The whole city shall flee for the noise of the horsemen and bowmen; they shall go into thickets, and climb up upon the rocks: every city shall be forsaken, and not a man dwell therein.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And when thou art spoiled, what wilt thou do? Though thou clothest thyself with crimson, though thou deckest thee with ornaments of gold, though thou rentest thy face with painting, in vain shalt thou make thyself fair; thy lovers will despise thee, they will seek thy life.</i></p> <p>31 <i>For I have heard a voice as of a woman in travail, and the anguish as of her that bringeth forth her first child, the voice of the daughter of Zion, that bewaileth herself, that spreadeth her hands, saying, Woe is me now! for my soul is wearied because of murderers.</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD says: "The whole land will be desolate, but I will not destroy it completely.</p> <p>Because of this the earth will mourn and the sky grow dark, because I have spoken and will not relent. I have decided and will not turn back."</p> <p>Every city will flee at the sound of the horsemen and archers. They will go into the thickets and climb among the rocks. Every city will be abandoned and no one will live in them.</p> <p>You who are ruined, what will You do? Even if You dress in scarlet and put on gold jewelry, even if You paint Your eyes — you make Yourself beautiful for nothing. Your lovers despise You. They want to kill You.</p> <p>I hear a cry like that of a woman in labor, the anguish of a mother giving birth to her first child — the voice of Daughter Zion gasping for breath and stretching out her hands, saying, "How terrible for me! I am fainting before killers!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN*-tylz) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 2:12; Jer 3:22; Ezek 43:9; Jer 25:5; Gen 35:2
v2 — Isa 65:16; Jer 9:24; Gen 22:18; 2 Cor 10:17; 1 Cor 1:31
v3 — Hos 10:12; Luke 8:14; Luke 8:7; Gal 6:7-8; Mark 4:18-19
v4 — Deut 10:16; Deut 30:6; Rom 2:28-29; Col 2:11; Jer 9:26
v7 — Isa 1:7; Jer 5:6; Isa 6:11; Jer 2:15; Ezek 26:7-10
v13 — Isa 19:1; Isa 66:15; Hab 1:8; Isa 5:28; Lam 4:19
v14 — Jas 4:8; Isa 55:7; Acts 8:22; Luke 11:39; 1 Cor 3:20
v19 — Hab 3:16; Isa 22:4; Isa 16:11
v20 — Ps 42:7; Joel 1:15; Ezek 7:25-26; 2 Thess 1:9; Matt 10:28
v22 — 1 Cor 14:20; Rom 16:19; Jer 5:21; Rom 3:11; Hos 4:6
v23 — Matt 24:29; Mark 13:24-25; Joel 3:15-16; Isa 13:10; Gen 1:2
v28 — Num 23:19; Jer 12:4; Isa 50:3; Hos 4:3

Chapter 5

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to search the streets of Jerusalem for one man who executes judgment and seeks truth, and He would pardon the city. But the people had sworn falsely, refused correction, and broken the yoke. Their prophets prophesied lies and the priests ruled by their own power, and Jeremiah asked what would happen in the end.

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| <p>1 <i>Run ye to and fro through the streets of Jerusalem, and see now, and know, and seek in the broad places thereof, if ye can find a man, if there be any that executeth judgment, that seeketh the truth; and I will pardon it.</i></p> | <p>"Roam through the streets of Jerusalem. Look around and take note. Search the public squares. See if You can find one person who acts justly and seeks truth. If You find one, I will forgive this city.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And though they say, The LORD liveth; surely they swear falsely.</i></p> | <p>Even when they say, 'As the LORD lives,' they are swearing falsely."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>O LORD, are not thine eyes upon the truth? thou hast stricken them, but they have not grieved; thou hast consumed them, but they have refused to receive correction: they have made their faces harder than a rock; they have refused to return.</i></p> | <p>LORD, do Your eyes not look for truth? You struck them but they felt no pain. You crushed them but they refused to be corrected. They made their faces harder than rock and refused to return.</p> |

- 4 *Therefore I said, Surely these are poor; they are foolish: for they know not the way of the LORD, nor the judgment of their God.* I thought, "These are only the poor and foolish — they do not know the way of the LORD or the law of their God."
- 5 *I will get me unto the great men, and will speak unto them; for they have known the way of the LORD, and the judgment of their God: but these have altogether broken the yoke, and burst the bonds.* So I went to the leaders and spoke to them. They surely know the way of the LORD and the law of their God. But these also had broken the yoke together and snapped off the chains.
- 6 *Wherefore a lion out of the forest shall slay them, and a wolf of the evenings shall spoil them, a leopard shall watch over their cities: every one that goeth out thence shall be torn in pieces: because their transgressions are many, and their backslidings are increased.* Therefore a lion from the forest will attack them. A wolf from the desert will destroy them. A leopard will lurk near their cities. Everyone who comes out will be torn to pieces, because their transgressions are many and their rebellion is great.
- 7 *How shall I pardon thee for this? thy children have forsaken me, and sworn by them that are no gods: when I had fed them to the full, they then committed adultery, and assembled themselves by troops in the harlots' houses.* "How shall I pardon You for this? Your children have forsaken Me and sworn by gods that are not gods. When I had fed them to the full, they committed adultery and assembled themselves by troops in the harlots' houses.
- 8 *They were as fed horses in the morning: every one neighed after his neighbour's wife.* They are like well-fed, lusty stallions, each one neighing for another man's wife.
- 9 *Shall I not visit for these things? saith the LORD: and shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?* Should I not punish them for this?" says the LORD. "Should I not take revenge on a nation like this?"
- 10 *Go ye up upon her walls, and destroy; but make not a full end: take away her battlements; for they are not the LORD's.* Go through her vineyards and destroy them, but do not make a full end. Strip away her branches, for they do not belong to the LORD.

- 11 *For the house of Israel and the house of Judah have dealt very treacherously against me, saith the LORD.* The house of Israel and the house of Judah have been completely unfaithful to Me," says the LORD.
- 12 *They have belied the LORD, and said, It is not he; neither shall evil come upon us; neither shall we see sword nor famine:* They have lied about the LORD, saying, "He will do nothing. No disaster will come upon us. We will not see sword or famine.
- 13 *And the prophets shall become wind, and the word is not in them: thus shall it be done unto them.* The prophets are just hot air — the word of God is not in them. Let what they predict happen to them."
- 14 *Wherefore thus saith the LORD God of hosts, Because ye have spoken this word, behold, I will make my words in thy mouth fire, and this people wood, and it shall devour them.* Therefore this is what the LORD God of hosts says: "Because You have spoken this, I will make My words fire in Your mouth, and this people will be the wood it consumes.
- 15 *Lo, I will bring a nation upon you from far, O house of Israel, saith the LORD: it is a mighty nation, it is an ancient nation, a nation whose language thou knowest not, neither understandest what they say.* I am bringing a distant nation against You, Israel," says the LORD. "It is an enduring nation, an ancient nation, whose language You do not know and whose speech You do not understand.
- 16 *Their quiver is as an open sepulchre, they are all mighty men.* Their quivers are like open graves. They are all mighty warriors.
- 17 *And they shall eat up thine harvest, and thy bread, which thy sons and thy daughters should eat: they shall eat up thy flocks and thine herds: they shall eat up thy vines and thy fig trees: they shall impoverish thy fortified cities, wherein thou trustedst, with the sword.* They will devour Your harvest and Your food — what Your sons and daughters should have eaten. They will devour Your flocks and Your herds. They will devour Your vines and Your fig trees. With the sword they will destroy Your fortified cities in which You trust.
- 18 *Nevertheless in those days, saith the LORD, I will not make a full end with you.* "Yet even in those days," says the LORD, "I will not destroy You completely.

- 19 *And it shall come to pass, when ye shall say, Wherefore doth the LORD our God all these things unto us? then shalt thou answer them, Like as ye have forsaken me, and served strange gods in your land, so shall ye serve strangers in a land that is not yours.* When You ask, 'Why has the LORD our God done all this to us?' you will tell them: 'Just as You abandoned the LORD and served foreign gods in Your own land, so You will serve foreigners in a land that is not Your own.'
- 20 *Declare this in the house of Jacob, and publish it in Judah, saying,* "Announce this to the house of Jacob and proclaim it in Judah:
- 21 *Hear now this, O foolish people, and without understanding; which have eyes, and see not; which have ears, and hear not:* Listen to this, you foolish and senseless people — you who have eyes but do not see, who have ears but do not hear.
- 22 *Fear ye not me? saith the LORD: will ye not tremble at my presence, which have placed the sand for the bound of the sea by a perpetual decree, that it cannot pass it: and though the waves thereof toss themselves, yet can they not prevail; though they roar, yet can they not pass over it?* Do You not fear Me?" says the LORD. "Do You not tremble before Me? I placed the sand as the boundary for the sea — a permanent limit it cannot cross. The waves may toss but they cannot prevail. They may roar but they cannot pass over it.
- 23 *But this people hath a revolting and a rebellious heart; they are revolted and gone.* But this people has a stubborn and rebellious heart. They have turned away and left.
- 24 *Neither say they in their heart, Let us now fear the LORD our God, that giveth rain, both the former and the latter, in his season: he reserveth unto us the appointed weeks of the harvest.* They do not say in their hearts, 'Let us fear the LORD our God, Who gives the autumn and spring rains in season and keeps for us the appointed weeks of harvest.'
- 25 *Your iniquities have turned away these things, and your sins have withholden good from you.* Your iniquities have turned these blessings away. Your sins have kept good things from You.

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| <p>26 <i>For among my people are found wicked men: they lay wait, as he that setteth snares; they set a trap, they catch men.</i></p> <p>27 <i>As a cage is full of birds, so are their houses full of deceit: therefore they are become great, and waxen rich.</i></p> <p>28 <i>They are waxen fat, they shine: yea, they overpass the deeds of the wicked: they judge not the cause, the cause of the fatherless, yet they prosper; and the right of the needy do they not judge.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Shall I not visit for these things? saith the LORD: shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?</i></p> <p>30 <i>A wonderful and horrible thing is committed in the land;</i></p> <p>31 <i>The prophets prophesy falsely, and the priests bear rule by their means; and my people love to have it so: and what will ye do in the end thereof?</i></p> | <p>Among My people are wicked men who lurk like hunters crouching in ambush. They set traps to catch people.</p> <p>Like a cage full of birds, their houses are full of dishonest gain. They have become great and grown rich.</p> <p>They have grown fat and sleek. They have surpassed all the limits of evil. They do not defend the rights of the fatherless or plead the case of the needy.</p> <p>"Should I not punish them for this?" says the LORD. "Should I not take revenge on a nation like this?"</p> <p>Something horrible and shocking has happened in this land:</p> <p>The prophets prophesy lies. The priests rule by their own authority. And My people love it this way. But what will You do at the end of it all?"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 18:23-32; 2 Chr 16:9; Ezek 22:30; Ps 14:3; Isa 59:14-15
v7 — Josh 23:7; Gal 4:8; Deut 32:21; Jer 2:11; 1 Cor 8:4
v14 — Jer 23:29; Jer 1:9; Hos 6:5; Rev 11:5-6; 2 Kgs 1:10-14
v15 — Deut 28:49; Jer 4:16; Isa 33:19; Isa 28:11; Isa 5:26
v19 — 1 Kgs 9:8-9; Deut 28:47-48; Jer 22:8-9; Jer 13:22; Jer 16:13
v21 — Ezek 12:2; Acts 28:26; Isa 6:9-10; Rom 11:8; Matt 13:13-15
v22 — Job 38:10-11; Ps 104:9; Job 26:10; Deut 28:58; Prov 8:29

- v24 — Ps 147:8; Gen 8:22; Joel 2:23; Acts 14:17; Matt 5:45
 v25 — Isa 59:2; Ps 107:34; Ps 107:17; Jer 2:17-19; Deut 28:23-24
 v26 — Prov 1:11; Ps 64:5; Ezek 22:2-12; Jer 18:22; Ps 10:9-10
 v28 — Isa 1:23; Deut 32:15
 v31 — Ezek 13:6; Jer 14:14; Mic 2:11; 2 Tim 4:3-4; 2 Thess 2:9-11

Chapter 6

The LORD warned the children of Benjamin to flee from Jerusalem, for evil and destruction were coming from the north. The city was full of oppression, and the people had rejected the LORD's word. From the least to the greatest, everyone was given to covetousness, and the prophets and priests alike dealt falsely, crying 'Peace, peace' when there was no peace.

- | | | |
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| 1 | <i>O ye children of Benjamin, gather yourselves to flee out of the midst of Jerusalem, and blow the trumpet in Tekoa, and set up a sign of fire in Bethhaccerem: for evil appeareth out of the north, and great destruction.</i> | "Flee for safety, people of Benjamin! Run from Jerusalem! Sound the trumpet in Tekoa. Raise a signal fire over Beth-haccerem, for disaster looms from the north — great destruction. |
| 2 | <i>I have likened the daughter of Zion to a comely and delicate woman.</i> | I have likened the daughter of Zion to a beautiful and delicate woman. |
| 3 | <i>The shepherds with their flocks shall come unto her; they shall pitch their tents against her round about; they shall feed every one in his place.</i> | Shepherds with their flocks will come against her. They will set up their tents around her and each will graze in His own area. |
| 4 | <i>Prepare ye war against her; arise, and let us go up at noon. Woe unto us! for the day goeth away, for the shadows of the evening are stretched out.</i> | Prepare for war against her! Attack at noon. But we cry, 'How terrible for us — the day is fading and the evening shadows grow long.' |
| 5 | <i>Arise, and let us go by night, and let us destroy her palaces.</i> | Attack by night and destroy her fortresses!" |
| 6 | <i>For thus hath the LORD of hosts said, Hew ye down trees, and cast a mount against Jerusalem: this is the city to be visited; she is wholly oppression in the midst of her.</i> | This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Cut down her trees and build siege ramps against Jerusalem. This city must be punished. She is full of oppression. |

- 7 *As a fountain casteth out her waters, so she casteth out her wickedness: violence and spoil is heard in her; before me continually is grief and wounds.* As a well keeps its water fresh, so she keeps her evil fresh. Violence and destruction echo through her. Wounds and blows are all I see.
- 8 *Be thou instructed, O Jerusalem, lest my soul depart from thee; lest I make thee desolate, a land not inhabited.* Take warning, Jerusalem, or I will turn away from You and make You a wasteland — an uninhabited land."
- 9 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, They shall thoroughly glean the remnant of Israel as a vine: turn back thine hand as a grapegatherer into the baskets.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Let them thoroughly glean Israel like a vineyard. Pass Your hand again over the branches, like a grape picker."
- 10 *To whom shall I speak, and give warning, that they may hear? behold, their ear is uncircumcised, and they cannot hearken: behold, the word of the LORD is unto them a reproach; they have no delight in it.* To whom can I speak and give warning so they will listen? Their ears are closed — they cannot hear. The word of the LORD has become an offense to them. They find no pleasure in it.
- 11 *Therefore I am full of the fury of the LORD; I am weary with holding in: I will pour it out upon the children abroad, and upon the assembly of young men together: for even the husband with the wife shall be taken, the aged with him that is full of days.* So I am full of the LORD's fury. I am worn out from holding it in. "Pour it out on the children in the street and on the young men gathered together. For husband and wife alike will be taken, the old man and the very aged.
- 12 *And their houses shall be turned unto others, with their fields and wives together: for I will stretch out my hand upon the inhabitants of the land, saith the LORD.* Their houses will be turned over to others — their fields and wives too — for I will stretch out My hand against those who live in this land," says the LORD.
- 13 *For from the least of them even unto the greatest of them every one is given to covetousness; and from the prophet even unto the priest every one dealeth falsely.* "From the least to the greatest, all are greedy for profit. From prophet to priest, all practice deceit.

- 14 *They have healed also the hurt of the daughter of my people slightly, saying, Peace, peace; when there is no peace.* They treat my people's wounds as though they were nothing, saying, 'Peace, peace,' when there is no peace.
- 15 *Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? nay, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore they shall fall among them that fall: at the time that I visit them they shall be cast down, saith the LORD.* Were they ashamed when they did these detestable things? No — they were not ashamed at all. They did not even know how to blush. So they will fall among the fallen. When I punish them, they will stumble," says the LORD.
- 16 *Thus saith the LORD, Stand ye in the ways, and see, and ask for the old paths, where is the good way, and walk therein, and ye shall find rest for your souls. But they said, We will not walk therein.* This is what the LORD says: "Stand at the crossroads and look. Ask for the ancient paths — ask where the good way is — and walk in it. You will find rest for Your souls." But they said, "We will not walk in it."
- 17 *Also I set watchmen over you, saying, Hearken to the sound of the trumpet. But they said, We will not hearken.* I appointed watchmen over You and said, "Listen for the sound of the trumpet." But they said, "We will not listen."
- 18 *Therefore hear, ye nations, and know, O congregation, what is among them.* Therefore listen, You nations. Take note, you witnesses, of what is happening to them.
- 19 *Hear, O earth: behold, I will bring evil upon this people, even the fruit of their thoughts, because they have not hearkened unto my words, nor to my law, but rejected it.* Listen, earth: I am bringing disaster on this people — the result of their own scheming — because they have not listened to My words and have rejected My law.
- 20 *To what purpose cometh there to me incense from Sheba, and the sweet cane from a far country? your burnt offerings are not acceptable, nor your sacrifices sweet unto me.* What good to Me is the incense from Sheba or sweet cane from a distant land? Your burnt offerings are not acceptable. Your sacrifices do not please Me."

- 21 *Therefore thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will lay stumblingblocks before this people, and the fathers and the sons together shall fall upon them; the neighbour and his friend shall perish.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: "I will put obstacles before this people. Fathers and sons together will stumble over them. Neighbors and friends will perish."
- 22 *Thus saith the LORD, Behold, a people cometh from the north country, and a great nation shall be raised from the sides of the earth.* This is what the LORD says: "A people are coming from the land of the north. A great nation is being stirred up from the ends of the earth."
- 23 *They shall lay hold on bow and spear; they are cruel, and have no mercy; their voice roareth like the sea; and they ride upon horses, set in array as men for war against thee, O daughter of Zion.* They carry bow and spear. They are cruel and have no mercy. Their sound is like the roaring sea. They ride on horses, armed like men for battle against You, Daughter Zion."
- 24 *We have heard the fame thereof: our hands wax feeble: anguish hath taken hold of us, and pain, as of a woman in travail.* We have heard the report and our hands fall limp. Anguish grips us — pain like a woman in labor.
- 25 *Go not forth into the field, nor walk by the way; for the sword of the enemy and fear is on every side.* Do not go out into the fields or walk on the roads, for the enemy has a sword, and terror is on every side.
- 26 *O daughter of my people, gird thee with sackcloth, and wallow thyself in ashes: make thee mourning, as for an only son, most bitter lamentation: for the spoiler shall suddenly come upon us.* Put on sackcloth, my people, and roll in ashes. Mourn with bitter wailing as for an only son, for suddenly the destroyer will come upon us.
- 27 *I have set thee for a tower and a fortress among my people, that thou mayest know and try their way.* "I have made You a tester and a fortress among my people, so You may observe and examine their ways."
- 28 *They are all grievous revolters, walking with slanders: they are brass and iron; they are all corrupters.* They are all hardened rebels — they go about spreading slander. They are bronze and iron — all of them corrupt.

- 29

The bellows are burned, the lead is consumed of the fire; the founder melteth in vain: for the wicked are not plucked away.

The bellows blow fiercely. The lead burns up in the fire. The smelter keeps on working in vain — the wicked are not removed.
- 30

Reprobate silver shall men call them; because the LORD hath rejected them.

They are called rejected silver, because the LORD has rejected them."

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Cross-References:

- v7 — Ezek 7:11; Ezek 7:23; Jer 20:8
- v8 — Hos 9:12; Ezek 23:18
- v10 — Acts 7:51; Jer 7:26; John 7:7; Heb 11:7; Isa 53:1
- v11 — Jer 20:9; Jer 9:21
- v13 — Jer 23:11; Jer 8:10; Mic 3:11
- v14 — Ezek 13:10; Jer 23:17; Jer 4:10; Lam 2:14; Jer 14:13
- v15 — Jer 8:12; Jer 3:3; Matt 15:14
- v16 — Isa 30:21; Deut 32:7; Jer 18:15; Matt 11:28-29; Jer 7:23
- v17 — Jer 25:4; Isa 58:1; Zech 7:11; Isa 21:11
- v19 — Isa 1:2; Jer 17:10; Acts 8:22; Jer 8:9
- v27 — Jer 1:18; Jer 15:20
- v28 — Jer 9:4; Jer 5:23

Chapter 7

The LORD sent Jeremiah to the temple gate to warn the people not to trust in lying words -- 'The temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD' -- while they stole, murdered, committed adultery, and burned incense to Baal. He pointed to Shiloh, where He had set His name before, and destroyed it. He declared He would cast them out of His sight as He cast out Ephraim.

- 1

The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,

This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD:
- 2

Stand in the gate of the LORD's house, and proclaim there this word, and say, Hear the word of the LORD, all ye of Judah, that enter in at these gates to worship the LORD.

"Stand at the gate of the LORD's house and proclaim this message there. Say, 'Hear the word of the LORD, all You people of Judah who come through these gates to worship the LORD.'

- 3 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, Amend your ways and your doings, and I will cause you to dwell in this place.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Reform Your ways and Your actions and I will let You live in this place.
- 4 *Trust ye not in lying words, saying, The temple of the LORD, The temple of the LORD, The temple of the LORD, are these.* Do not trust in these deceptive words: 'This is the temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD!'
- 5 *For if ye thoroughly amend your ways and your doings; if ye thoroughly execute judgment between a man and his neighbour;* If You truly reform Your ways and Your actions — if You truly administer justice between people —
- 6 *If ye oppress not the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, and shed not innocent blood in this place, neither walk after other gods to your hurt:* if You do not oppress the foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow, and do not shed innocent blood in this place, and if You do not follow other gods to Your own harm —
- 7 *Then will I cause you to dwell in this place, in the land that I gave to your fathers, for ever and ever.* then I will let You live in this place, in the land I gave Your ancestors forever and ever.
- 8 *Behold, ye trust in lying words, that cannot profit.* But look — you are trusting in deceptive words that are worthless.
- 9 *Will ye steal, murder, and commit adultery, and swear falsely, and burn incense unto Baal, and walk after other gods whom ye know not;* You steal and murder, commit adultery and perjury, burn incense to Baal, and follow other gods You have not known before.
- 10 *And come and stand before me in this house, which is called by my name, and say, We are delivered to do all these abominations?* Then You come and stand before Me in this house that bears My name and say, "We are safe!" — so You can go on doing all these detestable things.
- 11 *Is this house, which is called by my name, become a den of robbers in your eyes? Behold, even I have seen it, saith the LORD.* Has this house, which bears My name, become a den of robbers in Your eyes? I have been watching!" declares the LORD.

- 12 *But go ye now unto my place which was in Shiloh, where I set my name at the first, and see what I did to it for the wickedness of my people Israel.* "Go now to the place in Shiloh where I first made My name to dwell and see what I did to it because of the wickedness of My people Israel.
- 13 *And now, because ye have done all these works, saith the LORD, and I spake unto you, rising up early and speaking, but ye heard not; and I called you, but ye answered not;* And now, because You have done all these things," says the LORD, "and because I spoke to You again and again but You did not listen, and I called You but You did not answer —
- 14 *Therefore will I do unto this house, which is called by my name, wherein ye trust, and unto the place which I gave to you and to your fathers, as I have done to Shiloh.* therefore I will do to this house which bears My name — the place You trust in, the place I gave to You and Your ancestors — what I did to Shiloh.
- 15 *And I will cast you out of my sight, as I have cast out all your brethren, even the whole seed of Ephraim.* I will drive You out of My presence, just as I drove out all Your relatives, all the people of Ephraim."
- 16 *Therefore pray not thou for this people, neither lift up cry nor prayer for them, neither make intercession to me: for I will not hear thee.* "So do not pray for this people. Do not offer any plea or prayer for them. Do not plead with Me, for I will not listen to You.
- 17 *Seest thou not what they do in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?* Do You not see what they are doing in the towns of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?
- 18 *The children gather wood, and the fathers kindle the fire, and the women knead their dough, to make cakes to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto other gods, that they may provoke me to anger.* The children gather wood, the fathers light the fire, and the women knead the dough and make cakes to offer to the Queen of Heaven. They pour out drink offerings to other gods to arouse My anger.
- 19 *Do they provoke me to anger? saith the LORD: do they not provoke themselves to the confusion of their own faces?* But am I the one they are provoking?" says the LORD. "Are they not rather harming themselves, to their own shame?"

- 20 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, mine anger and my fury shall be poured out upon this place, upon man, and upon beast, and upon the trees of the field, and upon the fruit of the ground; and it shall burn, and shall not be quenched.* Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "My anger and My fury will be poured out on this place — on people and animals, on the trees of the field and the crops of the ground. It will burn and not be quenched."
- 21 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Put your burnt offerings unto your sacrifices, and eat flesh.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Go ahead and add Your burnt offerings to Your other sacrifices and eat the meat yourselves!"
- 22 *For I spake not unto your fathers, nor commanded them in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, concerning burnt offerings or sacrifices:* For when I brought Your ancestors out of Egypt, I did not speak to them or command them about burnt offerings and sacrifices.
- 23 *But this thing commanded I them, saying, Obey my voice, and I will be your God, and ye shall be my people: and walk ye in all the ways that I have commanded you, that it may be well unto you.* But this is what I commanded them: 'Obey Me and I will be Your God and You will be My people. Walk in all the ways I command You, so that it may go well with You.'
- 24 *But they hearkened not, nor inclined their ear, but walked in the counsels and in the imagination of their evil heart, and went backward, and not forward.* But they did not listen or pay attention. Instead they followed the stubbornness of their evil hearts. They went backward and not forward.
- 25 *Since the day that your fathers came forth out of the land of Egypt unto this day I have even sent unto you all my servants the prophets, daily rising up early and sending them:* From the day Your ancestors came out of Egypt until now, I sent My servants the prophets to You day after day.

- 26 *Yet they hearkened not unto me, nor inclined their ear, but hardened their neck: they did worse than their fathers.* But they did not listen to Me or pay attention. They were stiff-necked and did more evil than their ancestors.
- 27 *Therefore thou shalt speak all these words unto them; but they will not hearken to thee: thou shalt also call unto them; but they will not answer thee.* When You tell them all this, they will not listen to You. When You call to them, they will not answer.
- 28 *But thou shalt say unto them, This is a nation that obeyeth not the voice of the LORD their God, nor receiveth correction: truth is perished, and is cut off from their mouth.* So say to them, "This is the nation that has not obeyed the LORD its God or accepted correction. Truth has perished — it has vanished from their mouths."
- 29 *Cut off thine hair, O Jerusalem, and cast it away, and take up a lamentation on high places: for the LORD hath rejected and forsaken the generation of his wrath.* Cut off Your hair and throw it away. Take up a lament on the barren heights, for the LORD has rejected and abandoned this generation that is under His wrath."
- 30 *For the children of Judah have done evil in my sight, saith the LORD: they have set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to pollute it.* "The people of Judah have done evil in My eyes," says the LORD. "They have set up their detestable idols in the house that bears My name and have defiled it.
- 31 *And they have built the high places of Tophet, which is in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire; which I commanded them not, neither came it into my heart.* They have built the high places of Topheth in the Valley of Ben Hinnom to burn their sons and daughters in the fire — something I never commanded, nor did it enter My mind.

- 32 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that it shall no more be called Tophet, nor the valley of the son of Hinnom, but the valley of slaughter: for they shall bury in Tophet, till there be no place.* So the days are coming," says the LORD, "when it will no longer be called Topheth or the Valley of Ben Hinnom, but the Valley of Slaughter. They will bury the dead in Topheth until there is no room.
- 33 *And the carcasses of this people shall be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth; and none shall fray them away.* The bodies of this people will be food for the birds of the air and the animals of the earth. No one will drive them away.
- 34 *Then will I cause to cease from the cities of Judah, and from the streets of Jerusalem, the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride: for the land shall be desolate.* I will end the sounds of joy and gladness and the voices of the bride and groom in the towns of Judah and the streets of Jerusalem, for the land will become a wasteland."

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

- v4** — Mic 3:11; Zeph 3:11; Matt 3:9-10
v6 — Zech 7:9-12; Deut 8:19; Ex 22:21-24; Jer 13:10; Deut 11:28
v11 — Luke 19:45-46; Isa 56:7; Matt 21:13; Mark 11:17; 2 Chr 6:33
v12 — 1 Sam 4:10-11; Jer 26:6; Josh 18:1; Judg 18:31; Ps 78:60-64
v13 — Isa 65:12; Prov 1:24; 2 Chr 36:15-16; Jer 7:25
v16 — Jer 11:14; Jer 14:11-12; Jer 15:1; Isa 1:15; Ezek 14:14-20
v20 — Jer 42:18; Jer 17:27; Isa 42:25; Lam 2:3-5
v22 — Hos 6:6; 1 Sam 15:22; Ps 51:16-17; Matt 9:13; Ps 40:6
v23 — Ex 15:26; Deut 5:33; Ex 19:5-6; Heb 5:9; Jer 42:6
v24 — Ps 81:11-12; Jer 8:5; Jer 7:26; Deut 29:19
v31 — 2 Kgs 23:10; 2 Kgs 17:17; Lev 18:21; Jer 32:35; Deut 12:31
v34 — Rev 18:23; Ezek 26:13; Hos 2:11

Chapter 8

The LORD declared that the bones of Jerusalem's kings, priests, and prophets would be spread before the sun and moon they had worshiped. The people refused to return, and even the stork knows her appointed times, but God's people do not know His judgment. Jeremiah wept for the hurt of his people, asking whether there was no balm in Gilead and no physician there.

- 1 *At that time, saith the LORD, they shall bring out the bones of the kings of Judah, and the bones of his princes, and the bones of the priests, and the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, out of their graves:*

"At that time," says the LORD, "the bones of the kings of Judah, the bones of its officials, the bones of the priests, the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the people of Jerusalem will be brought out of their graves.
- 2 *And they shall spread them before the sun, and the moon, and all the host of heaven, whom they have loved, and whom they have served, and after whom they have walked, and whom they have sought, and whom they have worshipped: they shall not be gathered, nor be buried; they shall be for dung upon the face of the earth.*

They will be spread out before the sun and the moon and all the stars of the sky — the things they loved and served and followed and consulted and worshiped. They will not be gathered up or buried but will be like dung on the surface of the ground.
- 3 *And death shall be chosen rather than life by all the residue of them that remain of this evil family, which remain in all the places whither I have driven them, saith the LORD of hosts.*

And death will be preferred to life by all the survivors of this evil family who remain in all the places where I have driven them," says the LORD of hosts.
- 4 *Moreover thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD; Shall they fall, and not arise? shall he turn away, and not return?*

"Say to them, "This is what the LORD says: When people fall down, do they not get up? When someone turns away, do they not return?
- 5 *Why then is this people of Jerusalem slidden back by a perpetual backsliding? they hold fast deceit, they refuse to return.*

Why then have these people of Jerusalem turned away? Why do they cling to deceit and refuse to return?

- 6 *I hearkened and heard, but they spake not aright: no man repented him of his wickedness, saying, What have I done? every one turned to his course, as the horse rusheth into the battle.* I have listened carefully but they do not say what is right. Not one of them repents of their wickedness by asking, "What have I done?" Each one keeps charging ahead like a horse rushing into battle.
- 7 *Yea, the stork in the heaven knoweth her appointed times; and the turtle and the crane and the swallow observe the time of their migration; but my people know not the judgment of the LORD.* Even the stork in the sky knows its appointed seasons. The dove, the swift, and the thrush observe the time of their migration. But My people do not know the requirements of the LORD.
- 8 *How do ye say, We are wise, and the law of the LORD is with us? Lo, certainly in vain made he it; the pen of the scribes is in vain.* How can You say, "We are wise and we have the law of the LORD"? Actually, the lying pen of the scribes has handled it falsely.
- 9 *The wise men are ashamed, they are dismayed and taken: lo, they have rejected the word of the LORD; and what wisdom is in them?* The wise will be put to shame. They will be dismayed and caught. They have rejected the word of the LORD — what kind of wisdom do they have?
- 10 *Therefore will I give their wives unto others, and their fields to them that shall inherit them: for every one from the least even unto the greatest is given to covetousness, from the prophet even unto the priest every one dealeth falsely.* Therefore I will give their wives to other men and their fields to new owners. From the least to the greatest, all are greedy for gain. From prophet to priest, all practice deceit.
- 11 *For they have healed the hurt of the daughter of my people slightly, saying, Peace, peace; when there is no peace.* They dress the wound of my people as though it were nothing, saying, "Peace, peace," when there is no peace.

- 12 *Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? nay, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore shall they fall among them that fall: in the time of their visitation they shall be cast down, saith the LORD.* Were they ashamed when they committed these detestable acts? No — they felt no shame at all. They did not even know how to blush. So they will fall among the fallen. When they are punished, they will stumble," says the LORD.
- 13 *I will surely consume them, saith the LORD: there shall be no grapes on the vine, nor figs on the fig tree, and the leaf shall fade; and the things that I have given them shall pass away from them.* "I will take away their harvest," says the LORD. "There will be no grapes on the vine, no figs on the fig tree, and the leaves will wither. What I have given them will be taken away."
- 14 *Why do we sit still? assemble yourselves, and let us enter into the defenced cities, and let us be silent there: for the LORD our God hath put us to silence, and given us water of gall to drink, because we have sinned against the LORD.* Why are we sitting here? Gather together! Let us flee to the fortified cities and perish there, for the LORD our God has doomed us to perish. He has given us poisoned water to drink, because we have sinned against the LORD.
- 15 *We looked for peace, but no good came; and for a time of health, but behold trouble!* We hoped for peace but no good has come. We hoped for a time of healing but found only terror.
- 16 *The snorting of his horses was heard from Dan: the whole land trembled at the sound of the neighing of his strong ones; for they are come, and have devoured the land, and all that is in it; the city, and those that dwell therein.* The snorting of the enemy's horses is heard from Dan. The whole land trembles at the sound of the neighing of their powerful horses. They have come to devour the land and everything in it — the city and all who live there.
- 17 *For, behold, I will send serpents, cockatrices, among you, which will not be charmed, and they shall bite you, saith the LORD.* "I am sending poisonous snakes among You, vipers that cannot be charmed. They will bite You," says the LORD.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 18 <i>When I would comfort myself against sorrow, my heart is faint in me.</i> | My grief is beyond healing. My heart is sick within me. |
| 19 <i>Behold the voice of the cry of the daughter of my people because of them that dwell in a far country: Is not the LORD in Zion? is not her king in her? Why have they provoked me to anger with their graven images, and with strange vanities?</i> | Listen to the cry of my people from a land far away: "Is the LORD not in Zion? Is her King not there?" "Why have they provoked Me to anger with their carved images and their foreign idols?" |
| 20 <i>The harvest is past, the summer is ended, and we are not saved.</i> | "The harvest is past, the summer has ended, and we are not saved." |
| 21 <i>For the hurt of the daughter of my people am I hurt; I am black; astonishment hath taken hold on me.</i> | Since my people are broken, I am broken. I mourn — horror seizes me. |
| 22 <i>Is there no balm in Gilead; is there no physician there? why then is not the health of the daughter of my people recovered?</i> | Is there no medicine in Gilead? Is there no physician there? Why then has the healing of my people not come? |

Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 4:19; 2 Kgs 23:5
- v3 — Rev 9:6; Jer 29:14; Jer 23:8; Jer 23:3
- v4 — Prov 24:16; Hos 6:1; Mic 7:8; Isa 55:7; Jer 3:1
- v5 — Jer 9:6; Zech 7:11; Jer 5:3
- v6 — Ps 14:2
- v7 — Isa 1:3; Jer 5:4-5
- v8 — Isa 10:1-2; John 9:41; Job 5:12-13
- v10 — Jer 6:12-13
- v13 — Matt 21:19; Joel 1:7
- v14 — Jer 23:15; Jer 9:15
- v20 — Matt 25:1-12; Luke 13:25; Prov 10:5
- v22 — Jer 46:11; Gen 37:25; Jer 51:8; Jer 30:12-17; Luke 8:43

Chapter 9

Jeremiah wished his head were waters and his eyes a fountain of tears to weep day and night for his slain people. The LORD declared He would scatter them among nations they did not know, because they had forsaken His law. Let not the wise glory in wisdom, nor the mighty in might, nor the rich in riches, but let him who glories glory in knowing the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>Oh that my head were waters, and mine eyes a fountain of tears, that I might weep day and night for the slain of the daughter of my people!</i> | If only my head were a spring of water and my eyes a fountain of tears — I would weep day and night for the dead of my people. |
| 2 | <i>Oh that I had in the wilderness a lodging place of wayfaring men; that I might leave my people, and go from them! for they be all adulterers, an assembly of treacherous men.</i> | If only I had a traveler's shelter in the desert, I would leave my people and go away from them. They are all adulterers — a crowd of traitors. |
| 3 | <i>And they bend their tongues like their bow for lies: but they are not valiant for the truth upon the earth; for they proceed from evil to evil, and they know not me, saith the LORD.</i> | "They bend their tongues like bows to shoot lies. They are not faithful to truth in the land. They go from one evil to another. They do not know Me," says the LORD. |
| 4 | <i>Take ye heed every one of his neighbour, and trust ye not in any brother: for every brother will utterly supplant, and every neighbour will walk with slanders.</i> | "Be on Your guard against Your friends. Do not trust any relative. Every brother is a deceiver and every friend spreads slander. |
| 5 | <i>And they will deceive every one his neighbour, and will not speak the truth: they have taught their tongue to speak lies, and weary themselves to commit iniquity.</i> | Friend deceives friend and no one tells the truth. They have trained their tongues to lie. They exhaust themselves with sinning. |
| 6 | <i>Thine habitation is in the midst of deceit; through deceit they refuse to know me, saith the LORD.</i> | You live in the midst of deception. In their deceit they refuse to know Me," says the LORD. |

- 7 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, I will melt them, and try them; for how shall I do for the daughter of my people?* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts says: "I will refine and test them, for what else can I do because of the sin of my people?"
- 8 *Their tongue is as an arrow shot out; it speaketh deceit: one speaketh peaceably to his neighbour with his mouth, but in heart he layeth his wait.* Their tongue is a deadly arrow. It speaks deceit. With their mouths they speak peace to their neighbors but in their hearts they set a trap for them.
- 9 *Shall I not visit them for these things? saith the LORD: shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?* Should I not punish them for this?" says the LORD. "Should I not take revenge on a nation like this?"
- 10 *For the mountains will I take up a weeping and wailing, and for the habitations of the wilderness a lamentation, because they are burned up, so that none can pass through them; neither can men hear the voice of the cattle; both the fowl of the heavens and the beast are fled; they are gone.* I will weep and wail over the mountains and take up a lament over the wilderness pastures. They are so desolate that no one travels through. The lowing of cattle is not heard. The birds of the air have flown and the animals are gone.
- 11 *And I will make Jerusalem heaps, and a den of dragons; and I will make the cities of Judah desolate, without an inhabitant.* "I will make Jerusalem a heap of ruins — a haunt of jackals. I will make the towns of Judah desolate with no one living in them."
- 12 *Who is the wise man, that may understand this? and who is he to whom the mouth of the LORD hath spoken, that he may declare it, for what the land perisheth and is burned up like a wilderness, that none passeth through?* Who is wise enough to understand this? Who has been taught by the LORD to declare why the land is ruined and laid waste like a desert that no one passes through?
- 13 *And the LORD saith, Because they have forsaken my law which I set before them, and have not obeyed my voice, neither walked therein;* The LORD says: "Because they have abandoned My law which I set before them, and have not obeyed Me or followed My law —

- 14 *But have walked after the imagination of their own heart, and after Baalim, which their fathers taught them:* instead they have followed the stubbornness of their own hearts and have gone after the Baals, as their fathers taught them to do."
- 15 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will feed them, even this people, with wormwood, and give them water of gall to drink.* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "I will feed this people with bitter food and give them poisoned water to drink.
- 16 *I will scatter them also among the heathen, whom neither they nor their fathers have known: and I will send a sword after them, till I have consumed them.* I will scatter them among nations that neither they nor their ancestors have known. I will pursue them with the sword until I have destroyed them."
- 17 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Consider ye, and call for the mourning women, that they may come; and send for cunning women, that they may come:* This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Think about this and call for the wailing women to come. Send for the most skillful of them.
- 18 *And let them make haste, and take up a wailing for us, that our eyes may run down with tears, and our eyelids gush out with waters.* Let them come quickly and wail over us, till our eyes overflow with tears and water streams from our eyelids.
- 19 *For a voice of wailing is heard out of Zion, How are we spoiled! we are greatly confounded, because we have forsaken the land, because our dwellings have cast us out.* The sound of wailing is heard from Zion: "We are ruined! We are deeply shamed because we have been driven from the land and our homes have been torn down."
- 20 *Yet hear the word of the LORD, O ye women, and let your ear receive the word of his mouth, and teach your daughters wailing, and every one her neighbour lamentation.* Now listen, You women, to the word of the LORD. Open your ears to the words of His mouth. Teach Your daughters how to wail and each one her neighbor how to lament.

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| <p>21 <i>For death is come up into our windows, and is entered into our palaces, to cut off the children from without, and the young men from the streets.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Speak, Thus saith the LORD, Even the carcasses of men shall fall as dung upon the open field, and as the handful after the harvestman, and none shall gather them.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Thus saith the LORD, Let not the wise man glory in his wisdom, neither let the mighty man glory in his might, let not the rich man glory in his riches:</i></p> <p>24 <i>But let him that glorieth glory in this, that he understandeth and knoweth me, that I am the LORD which exercise lovingkindness, judgment, and righteousness, in the earth: for in these things I delight, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will punish all them which are circumcised with the uncircumcised;</i></p> <p>26 <i>Egypt, and Judah, and Edom, and the children of Ammon, and Moab, and all that are in the utmost corners, that dwell in the wilderness: for all these nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in the heart.</i></p> | <p>"Death has climbed through our windows and entered our palaces. It has cut off the children from the streets and the young men from the public squares."</p> <p>Say, "This is what the LORD declares: Dead bodies will lie like manure on the open field, like cut grain behind the reaper with no one to gather them."</p> <p>This is what the LORD says: "Let not the wise boast of their wisdom. Let not the strong boast of their strength. Let not the rich boast of their riches.</p> <p>But let those who boast boast in this — that they understand and know Me, that I am the LORD, Who exercises mercy, justice, and righteousness on earth. In these I delight," says the LORD.</p> <p>"The days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will punish all who are circumcised only in the flesh —</p> <p>Egypt, Judah, Edom, Ammon, Moab, and all who live in the wilderness in distant places. For all these nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel is uncircumcised in heart."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammon (AM-on) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 22:4; Jer 13:17; Jer 8:21-22; Lam 2:11
- v3 — Jer 4:22; Jer 9:8; Judg 2:10; Isa 59:13-15; Rom 3:13
- v4 — Mic 7:5-6; Prov 26:24-25; Ps 12:2-3; Jer 6:28; Lev 19:16
- v7 — Isa 1:25; Mal 3:3; Isa 48:10; Jer 6:27; Zech 13:9
- v8 — Ps 28:3; Prov 26:24-26; Ps 120:3
- v10 — Jer 12:4; Hos 4:3
- v16 — Ezek 5:2; Ezek 5:12; Deut 28:64; Lev 26:33
- v17 — Amos 5:16-17; Eccl 12:5
- v20 — Luke 23:27-30; Isa 32:9-13; Job 22:22
- v23 — 1 Cor 1:27-29; Isa 5:21; Eccl 9:11; Rom 1:22; 1 Cor 3:18-20
- v24 — 2 Cor 10:17; Gal 6:14; 1 Cor 1:31; Mic 6:8; Mic 7:18
- v25 — Rom 2:8-9; Gal 5:2-6; Rom 2:25-26

Chapter 10

The LORD warned Israel not to learn the ways of the nations or be dismayed at the signs of heaven. He mocked the idols -- wooden figures overlaid with gold and silver that cannot speak, walk, or do any good or evil. The LORD is the true God, the living God and everlasting King, who made the earth by His power and the world by His wisdom.

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| 1 | <i>Hear ye the word which the LORD speaketh unto you, O house of Israel:</i> | Hear the word that the LORD speaks to You, house of Israel. |
| 2 | <i>Thus saith the LORD, Learn not the way of the heathen, and be not dismayed at the signs of heaven; for the heathen are dismayed at them.</i> | This is what the LORD says: "Do not learn the ways of the nations or be terrified by the signs in the sky, even though the nations are terrified by them. |
| 3 | <i>For the customs of the people are vain: for one cutteth a tree out of the forest, the work of the hands of the workman, with the axe.</i> | For the practices of the nations are worthless. They cut down a tree from the forest — the work of craftsmen with their axes. |
| 4 | <i>They deck it with silver and with gold; they fasten it with nails and with hammers, that it move not.</i> | They decorate it with silver and gold and fasten it with hammer and nails so it will not totter. |

- 5 *They are upright as the palm tree, but speak not: they must needs be borne, because they cannot go: be not afraid of them; for they cannot do evil, neither also is it in them to do good.* Like a scarecrow in a cucumber field, these idols cannot speak. They must be carried because they cannot walk. Do not fear them — they can do no harm, and they have no power to do good."
- 6 *Forasmuch as there is none like unto thee, O LORD; thou art great, and thy name is great in might.* There is no one like you, LORD. You are great and Your name is great in power.
- 7 *Who would not fear thee, O King of nations? for to thee doth it appertain: forasmuch as among all the wise men of the nations, and in all their kingdoms, there is none like unto thee.* Who should not fear You, King of the nations? That is what you deserve. Among all the wise of the nations and in all their kingdoms, there is no one like you.
- 8 *But they are altogether brutish and foolish: the stock is a doctrine of vanities.* They are all senseless and foolish. Their wooden idols teach nothing but lies.
- 9 *Silver spread into plates is brought from Tarshish, and gold from Uphaz, the work of the workman, and of the hands of the founder: blue and purple is their clothing: they are all the work of cunning men.* Hammered silver is brought from Tarshish and gold from Uphaz. What skilled craftsmen make, what goldsmiths fashion — they dress the idols in blue and purple. All of them are the work of skilled people.
- 10 *But the LORD is the true God, he is the living God, and an everlasting king: at his wrath the earth shall tremble, and the nations shall not be able to abide his indignation.* But the LORD is the true God. He is the living God, the eternal King. When He is angry the earth trembles. The nations cannot endure his wrath.
- 11 *Thus shall ye say unto them, The gods that have not made the heavens and the earth, even they shall perish from the earth, and from under these heavens.* Tell them this: "These gods, who did not make the heavens and the earth, will perish from the earth and from under the heavens."

- 12 *He hath made the earth by his power, he hath established the world by his wisdom, and hath stretched out the heavens by his discretion.* But God made the earth by His power. He founded the world by His wisdom and stretched out the heavens by His understanding.
- 13 *When he uttereth his voice, there is a multitude of waters in the heavens, and he causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth; he maketh lightnings with rain, and bringeth forth the wind out of his treasures.* When He thunders, the waters in the heavens roar. He makes clouds rise from the ends of the earth. He sends lightning with the rain and brings out the wind from His storehouses.
- 14 *Every man is brutish in his knowledge: every founder is confounded by the graven image: for his molten image is falsehood, and there is no breath in them.* Everyone is senseless and without knowledge. Every goldsmith is shamed by His idol. The images He makes are a fraud — they have no breath in them.
- 15 *They are vanity, and the work of errors: in the time of their visitation they shall perish.* They are worthless, the objects of mockery. When their punishment comes, they will be destroyed.
- 16 *The portion of Jacob is not like them: for he is the former of all things; and Israel is the rod of his inheritance: The LORD of hosts is his name.* He who is the Portion of Jacob is not like these, for he is the Maker of all things — including Israel, the tribe of His inheritance. The LORD of hosts is His name.
- 17 *Gather up thy wares out of the land, O inhabitant of the fortress.* Gather up Your belongings and prepare to leave the land, You who live under siege.
- 18 *For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will sling out the inhabitants of the land at this once, and will distress them, that they may find it so.* For this is what the LORD says: "At this time I will hurl out those who live in this land. I will bring distress on them so they will feel it."
- 19 *Woe is me for my hurt! my wound is grievous: but I said, Truly this is a grief, and I must bear it.* How terrible my wound is! My injury is severe. But I said, "This is my sickness and I must endure it."

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| <p>20 <i>My tabernacle is spoiled, and all my cords are broken: my children are gone forth of me, and they are not: there is none to stretch forth my tent any more, and to set up my curtains.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For the pastors are become brutish, and have not sought the LORD: therefore they shall not prosper, and all their flocks shall be scattered.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Behold, the noise of the bruit is come, and a great commotion out of the north country, to make the cities of Judah desolate, and a den of dragons.</i></p> <p>23 <i>O LORD, I know that the way of man is not in himself: it is not in man that walketh to direct his steps.</i></p> <p>24 <i>O LORD, correct me, but with judgment; not in thine anger, lest thou bring me to nothing.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Pour out thy fury upon the heathen that know thee not, and upon the families that call not on thy name: for they have eaten up Jacob, and devoured him, and consumed him, and have made his habitation desolate.</i></p> | <p>My tent is ruined and all its ropes are snapped. My children are gone from me and are no more. No one is left to set up my tent or hang the curtains.</p> <p>The shepherds are senseless and do not seek the LORD. So they do not prosper and all their flock is scattered.</p> <p>Listen! The report is coming — great commotion from the land of the north. It will make the towns of Judah desolate, a haunt of jackals.</p> <p>LORD, I know that people's lives are not their own. It is not for them to direct their own steps.</p> <p>Correct me, LORD, but with justice — not in Your anger, or You will reduce me to nothing.</p> <p>Pour out Your wrath on the nations that do not know you — on the peoples who do not call on Your name. For they have devoured Jacob, consuming him completely and destroying his homeland.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

v2 — Lev 20:23; Lev 18:3; Ezek 20:32; Luke 21:25-28; Deut 12:30-31

v3 — Isa 44:9-20; 1 Pet 1:18; Lev 18:30; Jer 10:8; Rom 1:21

v5 — Isa 46:7; 1 Cor 12:2; Isa 41:23-24; Ps 115:5-8

v6 — Ex 15:11; Ps 96:4; Ps 48:1; Deut 33:26; Ps 145:3

- v10** — Deut 32:4; Isa 57:15; Ps 76:7; Nah 1:6; Ps 31:5
v11 — Ps 96:5; Isa 2:18; Zech 13:2; Jer 10:15; Lam 3:66
v12 — Job 9:8; Gen 1:1; Prov 3:19; Isa 40:22; John 1:3
v14 — Ps 135:16-18; Ps 115:4-8; Isa 46:7-8; Hab 2:18-19; Isa 44:18-20
v16 — Deut 32:9; Jer 32:18; Jer 31:35; Jer 10:12; Jer 51:19
v21 — Jer 12:10; Ezek 34:2-10; Jer 23:1-2
v23 — Prov 20:24; Prov 16:1; Ps 37:23; Ps 119:116-117; Ps 17:5
v24 — Ps 38:1; Ps 6:1

Chapter 11

The LORD reminded Jeremiah of the covenant He made with Israel when He brought them out of Egypt, commanding them to obey His voice. The people of Judah and Jerusalem had broken that covenant and returned to the iniquities of their fathers. The men of Anathoth, Jeremiah's own town, plotted against his life, and the LORD declared He would punish them.

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| 1 | <i>The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,</i> | This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD: |
| 2 | <i>Hear ye the words of this covenant, and speak unto the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem;</i> | "Listen to the terms of this covenant and speak them to the people of Judah and to those who live in Jerusalem. |
| 3 | <i>And say thou unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel; Cursed be the man that obeyeth not the words of this covenant,</i> | Tell them this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Cursed is the man who does not obey the terms of this covenant — |
| 4 | <i>Which I commanded your fathers in the day that I brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, from the iron furnace, saying, Obey my voice, and do them, according to all which I command you: so shall ye be my people, and I will be your God:</i> | the covenant I commanded Your ancestors when I brought them out of Egypt, out of the iron-smelting furnace.' I said, 'Obey Me and do everything I command You. Then You will be My people and I will be Your God. |
| 5 | <i>That I may perform the oath which I have sworn unto your fathers, to give them a land flowing with milk and honey, as it is this day. Then answered I, and said, So be it, O LORD.</i> | Then I will fulfill the oath I swore to Your ancestors to give them a land flowing with milk and honey — as it is today.'" I said, "Amen, LORD." |

- 6 *Then the LORD said unto me, Proclaim all these words in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, saying, Hear ye the words of this covenant, and do them.* The LORD said to me, "Proclaim all these words in the towns of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem: 'Listen to the terms of this covenant and obey them.
- 7 *For I earnestly protested unto your fathers in the day that I brought them up out of the land of Egypt, even unto this day, rising early and protesting, saying, Obey my voice.* For I warned Your ancestors again and again from the day I brought them out of Egypt until today — warning them earnestly: Obey Me.
- 8 *Yet they obeyed not, nor inclined their ear, but walked every one in the imagination of their evil heart: therefore I will bring upon them all the words of this covenant, which I commanded them to do; but they did them not.* But they did not listen or pay attention. Instead they all followed the stubbornness of their evil hearts. So I brought on them all the curses of this covenant, which I commanded them to follow but which they did not keep."
- 9 *And the LORD said unto me, A conspiracy is found among the men of Judah, and among the inhabitants of Jerusalem.* The LORD said to me, "There is a conspiracy among the people of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
- 10 *They are turned back to the iniquities of their forefathers, which refused to hear my words; and they went after other gods to serve them: the house of Israel and the house of Judah have broken my covenant which I made with their fathers.* They have returned to the iniquities of their ancestors who refused to listen to My words. They have followed other gods to serve them. The house of Israel and the house of Judah have broken the covenant I made with their fathers.
- 11 *Therefore thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon them, which they shall not be able to escape; and though they shall cry unto me, I will not hearken unto them.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'I will bring on them a disaster they cannot escape. Though they cry out to Me, I will not listen to them.

- 12 *Then shall the cities of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem go, and cry unto the gods unto whom they offer incense: but they shall not save them at all in the time of their trouble.* The towns of Judah and the people of Jerusalem will go and cry out to the gods to whom they burn incense. But those gods will not save them at all when disaster strikes.
- 13 *For according to the number of thy cities were thy gods, O Judah; and according to the number of the streets of Jerusalem have ye set up altars to that shameful thing, even altars to burn incense unto Baal.* You have as many gods as You have towns, Judah. You have set up as many altars to burn incense to Baal as there are streets in Jerusalem.'
- 14 *Therefore pray not thou for this people, neither lift up a cry or prayer for them: for I will not hear them in the time that they cry unto me for their trouble.* So do not pray for this people. Do not offer any cry or prayer on their behalf, because I will not listen when they call to Me in the time of their distress.
- 15 *What hath my beloved to do in mine house, seeing she hath wrought lewdness with many, and the holy flesh is passed from thee? when thou doest evil, then thou rejoicest.* What does My beloved have to do in My house when she has done so many wicked things? Can the sacred meat avert Your punishment? When You do evil, You actually rejoice.
- 16 *The LORD called thy name, A green olive tree, fair, and of goodly fruit: with the noise of a great tumult he hath kindled fire upon it, and the branches of it are broken.* The LORD called You a thriving olive tree, beautiful and full of fine fruit. But with a roar of a mighty storm He will set it on fire, and its branches will be broken.
- 17 *For the LORD of hosts, that planted thee, hath pronounced evil against thee, for the evil of the house of Israel and of the house of Judah, which they have done against themselves to provoke me to anger in offering incense unto Baal.* The LORD of hosts, who planted You, has decreed disaster for You, because the house of Israel and the house of Judah have done evil — provoking Me by burning incense to Baal.

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| 18 <i>And the LORD hath given me knowledge of it, and I know it: then thou shewedst me their doings.</i> | The LORD revealed their plot to me so I knew about it, for at that time You showed me what they were doing. |
| 19 <i>But I was like a lamb or an ox that is brought to the slaughter; and I knew not that they had devised devices against me, saying, Let us destroy the tree with the fruit thereof, and let us cut him off from the land of the living, that his name may be no more remembered.</i> | I had been like a gentle lamb led to the slaughter. I did not know they had plotted against me, saying, "Let us destroy the tree with its fruit. Let us cut Him off from the land of the living, so His name will be remembered no more." |
| 20 <i>But, O LORD of hosts, that judgest righteously, that triest the reins and the heart, let me see thy vengeance on them: for unto thee have I revealed my cause.</i> | But You, LORD of hosts, who judge righteously and test the heart and mind — let me see Your vengeance on them, for to You I have committed my cause. |
| 21 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD of the men of Anathoth, that seek thy life, saying, Prophecy not in the name of the LORD, that thou die not by our hand:</i> | Therefore this is what the LORD says about the men of Anathoth who are seeking Your life and saying, "Do not prophesy in the name of the LORD or You will die by our hands" — |
| 22 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, I will punish them: the young men shall die by the sword; their sons and their daughters shall die by famine:</i> | this is what the LORD of hosts says: "I will punish them. Their young men will die by the sword. Their sons and daughters will die by famine. |
| 23 <i>And there shall be no remnant of them: for I will bring evil upon the men of Anathoth, even the year of their visitation.</i> | Not one of them will survive, because I will bring disaster on the men of Anathoth in the year of their punishment." |

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 11:6
- v3 — Deut 27:26; Deut 28:15-68; Deut 29:19-20; Gal 3:10-13
- v4 — Lev 26:12; Deut 4:20; Jer 7:22-23
- v8 — Jer 7:24
- v9 — Hos 6:9
- v10 — Deut 31:16; Ezek 16:59
- v11 — Prov 1:28; Isa 1:15; Ezek 8:18; Zech 7:13; Mic 3:4
- v14 — Jer 7:16; Jer 11:11; Jer 14:11; 1 John 5:16; Ex 32:10
- v16 — Rom 11:17-24
- v17 — Isa 5:2
- v19 — Isa 53:7-8; Jer 20:10; Ps 83:4; Jer 18:18; Ps 31:13
- v20 — Jer 20:12; Jer 17:10; 1 Sam 16:7; Ps 7:9; Jer 17:18

Chapter 12

Jeremiah asked the LORD why the way of the wicked prospers and the treacherous are at ease. The LORD answered that if Jeremiah could not keep up with footmen, how would he run with horses? The LORD declared He had forsaken His house and given His beloved into the hands of her enemies, but He would afterward return and have compassion and bring each nation back to their heritage.

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| <p>1 <i>Righteous art thou, O LORD, when I plead with thee: yet let me talk with thee of thy judgments: Wherefore doth the way of the wicked prosper? wherefore are all they happy that deal very treacherously?</i></p> | <p>You are always righteous, LORD, when I bring a case before You. Yet I want to speak with You about Your justice: Why does the way of the wicked prosper? Why do all the treacherous live at ease?</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thou hast planted them, yea, they have taken root: they grow, yea, they bring forth fruit: thou art near in their mouth, and far from their reins.</i></p> | <p>You have planted them and they have taken root. They grow and produce fruit. You are always on their lips but far from their hearts.</p> |

- 3 *But thou, O LORD, knowest me: thou hast seen me, and tried mine heart toward thee: pull them out like sheep for the slaughter, and prepare them for the day of slaughter.* But You know me, LORD. You see me and test my heart's attitude toward You. Drag them away like sheep to be slaughtered. Set them apart for the day of killing.
- 4 *How long shall the land mourn, and the herbs of every field wither, for the wickedness of them that dwell therein? the beasts are consumed, and the birds; because they said, He shall not see our last end.* How long will the land mourn and the grass of every field wither? Because of the wickedness of those who live there, the animals and birds have been swept away. Moreover, these people are saying, "He will not see what happens to us."
- 5 *If thou hast run with the footmen, and they have wearied thee, then how canst thou contend with horses? and if in the land of peace, wherein thou trustedst, they deal treacherously with thee, then how wilt thou do in the swelling of Jordan?* "If You have raced with men on foot and they have worn You out, how can You compete with horses? If You stumble in safe country, how will You manage in the thickets by the Jordan?"
- 6 *For even thy brethren, and the house of thy father, even they have dealt treacherously with thee; yea, they have called a multitude after thee: believe them not, though they speak fair words unto thee.* Even Your own brothers and Your father's family have betrayed You. They have raised a crowd to pursue You. Do not trust them, even when they speak kind words to You."
- 7 *I have forsaken mine house, I have left mine heritage; I have given the dearly beloved of my soul into the hand of her enemies.* "I will abandon My house. I will forsake My inheritance. I will give the one I love into the hands of her enemies.
- 8 *Mine heritage is unto me as a lion in the forest; it crieth out against me: therefore have I hated it.* My inheritance has become to Me like a lion in the forest. She roars at Me — so I have rejected her.

- 9 *Mine heritage is unto me as a speckled bird, the birds round about are against her; come ye, assemble all the beasts of the field, come to devour.* My inheritance is like a speckled bird of prey that other birds surround and attack. Come, gather all the wild animals. Bring them to devour.
- 10 *Many pastors have destroyed my vineyard, they have trodden my portion under foot, they have made my pleasant portion a desolate wilderness.* Many shepherds will ruin My vineyard. They will trample down My field. They will make My pleasant field a desolate wasteland.
- 11 *They have made it desolate, and being desolate it mourneth unto me; the whole land is made desolate, because no man layeth it to heart.* It will be made a wasteland — parched and desolate before Me. The whole land will be laid waste because no one takes it to heart.
- 12 *The spoilers are come upon all high places through the wilderness: for the sword of the LORD shall devour from the one end of the land even to the other end of the land: no flesh shall have peace.* Over all the barren heights in the desert, destroyers will come, for the sword of the LORD will devour from one end of the land to the other. No one will be safe.
- 13 *They have sown wheat, but shall reap thorns: they have put themselves to pain, but shall not profit: and they shall be ashamed of your revenues because of the fierce anger of the LORD.* They will plant wheat but harvest thorns. They will wear themselves out but gain nothing. They will be ashamed of their harvests because of the LORD's fierce anger."
- 14 *Thus saith the LORD against all mine evil neighbours, that touch the inheritance which I have caused my people Israel to inherit; Behold, I will pluck them out of their land, and pluck out the house of Judah from among them.* This is what the LORD says: "As for all My wicked neighbors who seize the inheritance I gave to My people Israel — I will uproot them from their lands and I will uproot the house of Judah from among them.

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| <p>15 <i>And it shall come to pass, after that I have plucked them out I will return, and have compassion on them, and will bring them again, every man to his heritage, and every man to his land.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And it shall come to pass, if they will diligently learn the ways of my people, to swear by my name, The LORD liveth; as they taught my people to swear by Baal; then shall they be built in the midst of my people.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But if they will not obey, I will utterly pluck up and destroy that nation, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>But after I have uprooted them, I will again have compassion on them and bring each one back to his own inheritance and his own land.</p> <p>And if they learn well the ways of My people and swear by My name, saying 'As the LORD lives' — just as they taught My people to swear by Baal — then they will be established among My people.</p> <p>But if any nation will not listen, I will completely uproot and destroy it," says the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mal 3:15; Ps 92:7; Ps 37:1; Ps 51:4; Ps 73:3-28
- v2 — Isa 29:13; Titus 1:16; Matt 15:8
- v3 — 2 Kgs 20:3; Jer 17:18; Ps 17:3; Ps 139:1-4
- v4 — Jer 9:10; Ps 107:34; Hos 4:3; Jer 4:25
- v5 — 1 Pet 4:12; Prov 24:10; Heb 12:3-4; Jer 50:44; Ps 42:7
- v6 — Prov 26:25; Ps 12:2; Jer 9:4; Mic 7:5-6; Gen 37:4-11
- v9 — Isa 56:9; Jer 7:33
- v11 — Isa 42:25; Jer 23:10
- v13 — Hag 1:6; Deut 28:38; Mic 6:15; Isa 55:2; Lev 26:16
- v14 — Zech 2:8; Jer 3:18
- v15 — Jer 49:6; Jer 48:47; Jer 49:39
- v16 — Jer 4:2; Zeph 1:5; Josh 23:7

Chapter 13

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to buy a linen girdle and hide it in a hole by the Euphrates; when he retrieved it, the girdle was ruined. So the LORD would ruin the pride of Judah and Jerusalem. He warned that every bottle would be filled with wine -- a symbol of drunkenness

and destruction -- and called the people to give glory to the LORD before He caused darkness.

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| 1 Thus saith the LORD unto me, Go and get thee a linen girdle, and put it upon thy loins, and put it not in water. | This is what the LORD said to me:
"Go and buy a linen belt and put it around Your waist, but do not let it touch water." |
| 2 So I got a girdle according to the word of the LORD, and put it on my loins. | So I bought the belt as the LORD directed and put it on. |
| 3 And the word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying, | Then the word of the LORD came to me a second time: |
| 4 Take the girdle that thou hast got, which is upon thy loins, and arise, go to Euphrates, and hide it there in a hole of the rock. | "Take the belt You bought and are wearing. Go now to the Euphrates and hide it there in a crevice in the rocks." |
| 5 So I went, and hid it by Euphrates, as the LORD commanded me. | So I went and hid it at the Euphrates, as the LORD commanded. |
| 6 And it came to pass after many days, that the LORD said unto me, Arise, go to Euphrates, and take the girdle from thence, which I commanded thee to hide there. | Many days later the LORD said to me, "Go to the Euphrates now and get the belt I told You to hide there." |
| 7 Then I went to Euphrates, and digged, and took the girdle from the place where I had hid it: and, behold, the girdle was marred, it was profitable for nothing. | So I went to the Euphrates and dug it up. I took the belt from the place where I had hidden it, but it was ruined and completely useless. |
| 8 Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying, | Then the word of the LORD came to me: |
| 9 Thus saith the LORD, After this manner will I mar the pride of Judah, and the great pride of Jerusalem. | "This is what the LORD says: In the same way I will ruin the pride of Judah and the great pride of Jerusalem. |

- 10 *This evil people, which refuse to hear my words, which walk in the imagination of their heart, and walk after other gods, to serve them, and to worship them, shall even be as this girdle, which is good for nothing.* These wicked people refuse to listen to My words. They follow the stubbornness of their own hearts and go after other gods to serve and worship them. They will be like this belt — completely useless.
- 11 *For as the girdle cleaveth to the loins of a man, so have I caused to cleave unto me the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah, saith the LORD; that they might be unto me for a people, and for a name, and for a praise, and for a glory: but they would not hear.* For just as a belt clings to a man's waist, so I bound the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah to Myself," says the LORD, "so they would be My people — My fame, My praise, and My glory. But they did not listen."
- 12 *Therefore thou shalt speak unto them this word; Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Every bottle shall be filled with wine: and they shall say unto thee, Do we not certainly know that every bottle shall be filled with wine?* "Tell them this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Every jar should be filled with wine.' They will reply, 'Don't we know very well that every jar should be filled with wine?'
- 13 *Then shalt thou say unto them, Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will fill all the inhabitants of this land, even the kings that sit upon David's throne, and the priests, and the prophets, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, with drunkenness.* Then tell them, 'This is what the LORD says: I am going to fill all who live in this land — the kings who sit on David's throne, the priests, the prophets, and all the people of Jerusalem — with drunkenness.
- 14 *And I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together, saith the LORD: I will not pity, nor spare, nor have mercy, but destroy them.* I will smash them against each other — parents and children alike,' says the LORD. 'I will allow no pity, mercy, or compassion. I will destroy them.'"
- 15 *Hear ye, and give ear; be not proud: for the LORD hath spoken.* Hear and pay attention. Do not be arrogant, for the LORD has spoken.

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| <p>16 Give glory to the LORD your God, before he cause darkness, and before your feet stumble upon the dark mountains, and, while ye look for light, he turn it into the shadow of death, and make it gross darkness.</p> | <p>Give glory to the LORD Your God before He brings darkness, before Your feet stumble on the darkening hills. You hope for light but He will turn it to deep darkness and change it to thick gloom.</p> |
| <p>17 But if ye will not hear it, my soul shall weep in secret places for your pride; and mine eye shall weep sore, and run down with tears, because the LORD's flock is carried away captive.</p> | <p>But if You do not listen, I will weep in secret because of Your pride. My eyes will weep bitterly, overflowing with tears, because the LORD's flock will be taken captive.</p> |
| <p>18 Say unto the king and to the queen, Humble yourselves, sit down: for your principalities shall come down, even the crown of your glory.</p> | <p>Say to the king and to the queen mother: "Humble yourselves and sit down, for your glorious crowns have fallen from your heads."</p> |
| <p>19 The cities of the south shall be shut up, and none shall open them: Judah shall be carried away captive all of it, it shall be wholly carried away captive.</p> | <p>The cities of the south shall be shut up with no one to open them. All Judah shall be carried away captive — wholly carried away captive.</p> |
| <p>20 Lift up your eyes, and behold them that come from the north: where is the flock that was given thee, thy beautiful flock?</p> | <p>Look up and see those who are coming from the north. Where is the flock that was entrusted to you — your beautiful flock?</p> |
| <p>21 What wilt thou say when he shall punish thee? for thou hast taught them to be captains, and as chief over thee: shall not sorrows take thee, as a woman in travail?</p> | <p>What will You say when the LORD sets over You those You Yourself taught to be Your allies? Will not pain grip You like that of a woman in labor?</p> |
| <p>22 And if thou say in thine heart, Wherefore come these things upon me? For the greatness of thine iniquity are thy skirts discovered, and thy heels made bare.</p> | <p>And if You ask Yourself, "Why has this happened to me?" — it is because of Your great iniquity that Your skirts have been torn off and Your body violated.</p> |

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| 23 | <i>Can the Ethiopian change his skin, or the leopard his spots? then may ye also do good, that are accustomed to do evil.</i> | Can an Ethiopian change His skin or a leopard its spots? Neither can You do good who are accustomed to doing evil. |
| 24 | <i>Therefore will I scatter them as the stubble that passeth away by the wind of the wilderness.</i> | "I will scatter You like chaff driven by the desert wind. |
| 25 | <i>This is thy lot, the portion of thy measures from me, saith the LORD; because thou hast forgotten me, and trusted in falsehood.</i> | This is Your lot — the portion I have decreed for you," says the LORD, "because You have forgotten Me and trusted in false gods. |
| 26 | <i>Therefore will I discover thy skirts upon thy face, that thy shame may appear.</i> | I will pull up Your skirts over Your face so Your shame may be seen — |
| 27 | <i>I have seen thine adulteries, and thy neighings, the lewdness of thy whoredom, and thine abominations on the hills in the fields. Woe unto thee, O Jerusalem! wilt thou not be made clean? when shall it once be?</i> | I have seen Your adulteries and Your neighings, the lewdness of Your whoredom and Your abominations on the hills in the fields. Woe to You, O Jerusalem! Will you not be made clean? When shall it once be?" |

Words in this chapter:

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v10** — Jer 16:12; Jer 9:14
v11 — Ex 19:5-6; Jer 33:9
v13 — Isa 51:17; Isa 63:6; Ps 75:8; Ps 60:3
v15 — Isa 28:14-22
v16 — Isa 59:9; Isa 8:22; Prov 4:19; Isa 60:2; Isa 5:30
v17 — Mal 2:2; Jer 9:1; Jer 14:17
v18 — Jer 22:26; 2 Kgs 24:12; 2 Kgs 24:15; 2 Chr 33:12; 2 Chr 33:19
v20 — Jer 6:22
v22 — Nah 3:5; Jer 16:10-11; Jer 5:19
v23 — Jer 2:22; Jer 9:5; Matt 19:24-28; Jer 17:9; Jer 2:30
v25 — Job 20:29; Ps 9:17

v26 — Lam 1:8; Hos 2:10

Chapter 14

The word of the LORD came to Jeremiah concerning the drought. Judah mourned, the ground was parched, and even the deer abandoned their young. The LORD told Jeremiah not to pray for the people's good, and He rejected their fasts and offerings. The prophets who prophesied peace would themselves be consumed by sword and famine.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah concerning the dearth.</i> | This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah concerning the drought: |
| 2 | <i>Judah mourneth, and the gates thereof languish; they are black unto the ground; and the cry of Jerusalem is gone up.</i> | "Judah mourns and its gates droop. The people sink to the ground in mourning, and the cry of Jerusalem goes up. |
| 3 | <i>And their nobles have sent their little ones to the waters: they came to the pits, and found no water; they returned with their vessels empty; they were ashamed and confounded, and covered their heads.</i> | The nobles send their servants for water. They go to the cisterns but find no water. They return with empty jars. In shame and misery they cover their heads. |
| 4 | <i>Because the ground is chapt, for there was no rain in the earth, the plowmen were ashamed, they covered their heads.</i> | The ground is cracked because there is no rain in the land. The farmers are dismayed and cover their heads. |
| 5 | <i>Yea, the hind also calved in the field, and forsook it, because there was no grass.</i> | Even the doe in the field deserts her newborn fawn because there is no grass. |
| 6 | <i>And the wild asses did stand in the high places, they snuffed up the wind like dragons; their eyes did fail, because there was no grass.</i> | Wild donkeys stand on the bare heights and pant for air like jackals. Their eyes grow dim because there is no food." |
| 7 | <i>O LORD, though our iniquities testify against us, do thou it for thy name's sake: for our backslidings are many; we have sinned against thee.</i> | Although our iniquities testify against us, LORD, act for the sake of Your name. Our unfaithfulness has been great. We have sinned against You. |

- 8 *O the hope of Israel, the saviour thereof in time of trouble, why shouldest thou be as a stranger in the land, and as a wayfaring man that turneth aside to tarry for a night?* You are the hope of Israel, its Savior in times of distress. Why should You be like a stranger in the land, like a traveler who only stays the night?
- 9 *Why shouldest thou be as a man astonished, as a mighty man that cannot save? yet thou, O LORD, art in the midst of us, and we are called by thy name; leave us not.* Why are You like a man taken by surprise, like a warrior who cannot save? You are among us, LORD, and we bear Your name. Do not forsake us!
- 10 *Thus saith the LORD unto this people, Thus have they loved to wander, they have not refrained their feet, therefore the LORD doth not accept them; he will now remember their iniquity, and visit their sins.* This is what the LORD says about this people: "They love to wander. They have not held back their feet. So the LORD does not accept them. He will now remember their iniquity and punish their sins."
- 11 *Then said the LORD unto me, Pray not for this people for their good.* Then the LORD said to me, "Do not pray for the good of this people.
- 12 *When they fast, I will not hear their cry; and when they offer burnt offering and an oblation, I will not accept them: but I will consume them by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence.* Even if they fast, I will not listen to their cry. Even if they offer burnt offerings and grain offerings, I will not accept them. Instead I will destroy them by sword, famine, and plague."
- 13 *Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! behold, the prophets say unto them, Ye shall not see the sword, neither shall ye have famine; but I will give you assured peace in this place.* I replied, "Ah, Lord GOD! The prophets keep telling them, 'You will not see the sword or suffer famine. Indeed, I will give You lasting peace in this place.'"

- 14 *Then the LORD said unto me, The prophets prophesy lies in my name: I sent them not, neither have I commanded them, neither spake I unto them: they prophesy unto you a false vision and divination, and a thing of nought, and the deceit of their heart.* The LORD said to me, "The prophets are prophesying lies in My name. I have not sent them or appointed them or spoken to them. They are prophesying to You false visions, worthless divinations, and the delusions of their own minds.
- 15 *Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that prophesy in my name, and I sent them not, yet they say, Sword and famine shall not be in this land; By sword and famine shall those prophets be consumed.* Therefore this is what the LORD says about the prophets who are prophesying in My name but whom I did not send — and who say 'No sword or famine will touch this land': Those same prophets will die by sword and famine.
- 16 *And the people to whom they prophesy shall be cast out in the streets of Jerusalem because of the famine and the sword; and they shall have none to bury them, them, their wives, nor their sons, nor their daughters: for I will pour their wickedness upon them.* And the people they are prophesying to will be thrown out into the streets of Jerusalem because of famine and the sword. There will be no one to bury them, their wives, their sons, or their daughters. I will pour on them the calamity they deserve.
- 17 *Therefore thou shalt say this word unto them; Let mine eyes run down with tears night and day, and let them not cease: for the virgin daughter of my people is broken with a great breach, with a very grievous blow.* "Speak this word to them: 'Let my eyes flow with tears night and day without stopping, for the virgin daughter of my people has suffered a crushing blow — a very serious wound.
- 18 *If I go forth into the field, then behold the slain with the sword! and if I enter into the city, then behold them that are sick with famine! yea, both the prophet and the priest go about into a land that they know not.* If I go out into the countryside, I see those killed by the sword. If I go into the city, I see the ravages of famine. Both prophet and priest have gone to a land they do not know."

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| <p>19 <i>Hast thou utterly rejected Judah? hath thy soul lothed Zion? why hast thou smitten us, and there is no healing for us? we looked for peace, and there is no good; and for the time of healing, and behold trouble!</i></p> <p>20 <i>We acknowledge, O LORD, our wickedness, and the iniquity of our fathers: for we have sinned against thee.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Do not abhor us, for thy name's sake, do not disgrace the throne of thy glory: remember, break not thy covenant with us.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Are there any among the vanities of the Gentiles that can cause rain? or can the heavens give showers? art not thou he, O LORD our God? therefore we will wait upon thee: for thou hast made all these things.</i></p> | <p>Have You completely rejected Judah? Do You despise Zion? Why have You struck us down with no healing for us? We hoped for peace but found no good. We hoped for a time of healing but found only terror.</p> <p>We acknowledge our wickedness, LORD — the iniquity of our fathers — for we have sinned against You.</p> <p>For the sake of Your name, do not reject us. Do not dishonor Your glorious throne. Remember Your covenant with us — do not break it.</p> <p>Do any of the worthless idols of the nations bring rain? Do the skies themselves send down showers? No — it is You, LORD our God. So our hope is in You, for You are the one who does all this.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v2 — Isa 3:26; Jer 8:21; 1 Sam 5:12

v4 — Joel 1:11; Joel 1:19-20

v7 — Ps 25:11; Jer 14:20-21; Hos 5:5; Jer 5:6; Isa 59:12

v8 — Jer 17:13; Jer 50:7; Isa 43:3; Ps 50:15

v10 — Hos 9:9; Ps 119:101; Hos 8:13

v11 — Jer 7:16; Jer 11:14

v12 — Jer 11:11; Prov 1:28; Ezek 8:18; Ezek 14:21; Jer 6:20

v14 — Ezek 13:6-7; Ezek 12:24; Jer 29:8-9; Isa 30:10-11; Jer 29:31

v17 — Jer 8:21; Lam 1:15-16; Lam 2:13; Jer 13:17; Jer 9:1

v18 — Ezek 7:15; Lam 1:20

v21 — Jer 14:7; Ps 106:45

v22 — Joel 2:23; Jer 5:24; Ps 135:7; Isa 30:23; Deut 32:21

Chapter 15

The LORD declared that even if Moses and Samuel stood before Him, He would not relent toward this people. He appointed four forms of destruction -- the sword, dogs, birds, and beasts. Jeremiah complained of his sorrow, and the LORD promised that if he returned and separated the precious from the worthless, Jeremiah would be as God's mouth and the LORD would save him from the hand of the terrible.

- 1 Then said the LORD unto me, Though Moses and Samuel stood before me, yet my mind could not be toward this people: cast them out of my sight, and let them go forth.*

The LORD said to me, "Even if Moses and Samuel were to stand before Me, My heart would not go out to this people. Send them away from My presence! Let them go!
- 2 And it shall come to pass, if they say unto thee, Whither shall we go forth? then thou shalt tell them, Thus saith the LORD; Such as are for death, to death; and such as are for the sword, to the sword; and such as are for the famine, to the famine; and such as are for the captivity, to the captivity.*

If they ask You, 'Where shall we go?' tell them, 'This is what the LORD says: Those destined for death, to death. Those for the sword, to the sword. Those for famine, to famine. Those for captivity, to captivity.'
- 3 And I will appoint over them four kinds, saith the LORD: the sword to slay, and the dogs to tear, and the fowls of the heaven, and the beasts of the earth, to devour and destroy.*

I will send four kinds of destroyers against them," says the LORD: "the sword to kill, the dogs to drag away, and the birds of the air and the wild animals to devour and destroy.
- 4 And I will cause them to be removed into all kingdoms of the earth, because of Manasseh the son of Hezekiah king of Judah, for that which he did in Jerusalem.*

I will make them a horror to all the kingdoms of the earth because of what Manasseh son of Hezekiah king of Judah did in Jerusalem.

- 5 *For who shall have pity upon thee, O Jerusalem? or who shall bemoan thee? or who shall go aside to ask how thou doest?* Who will have pity on you, Jerusalem? Who will mourn for you? Who will stop to ask how you are?
- 6 *Thou hast forsaken me, saith the LORD, thou art gone backward: therefore will I stretch out my hand against thee, and destroy thee; I am weary with repenting.* You have rejected Me," says the LORD. "You keep going backward. So I will reach out My hand and destroy You. I am weary of relenting.
- 7 *And I will fan them with a fan in the gates of the land; I will bereave them of children, I will destroy my people, since they return not from their ways.* I will winnow them with a winnowing fork at the gates of the land. I will bring bereavement and destruction on My people, for they have not changed their ways.
- 8 *Their widows are increased to me above the sand of the seas: I have brought upon them against the mother of the young men a spoiler at noonday: I have caused him to fall upon it suddenly, and terrors upon the city.* Their widows will be more numerous than the sand of the sea. At midday I will bring a destroyer against the mothers of their young men. Suddenly I will bring on them anguish and terror.
- 9 *She that hath borne seven languisheth: she hath given up the ghost; her sun is gone down while it was yet day: she hath been ashamed and confounded: and the residue of them will I deliver to the sword before their enemies, saith the LORD.* The mother of seven will grow faint and breathe her last. Her sun will set while it is still day. She will be disgraced and put to shame. As for the survivors, I will hand them over to the sword before their enemies," says the LORD.
- 10 *Woe is me, my mother, that thou hast borne me a man of strife and a man of contention to the whole earth! I have neither lent on usury, nor men have lent to me on usury; yet every one of them doth curse me.* Woe to me, my mother, that You gave birth to me — a man with whom the whole land strives and quarrels. I have not lent or borrowed money, yet everyone curses me.

- 11 *The LORD said, Verily it shall be well with thy remnant; verily I will cause the enemy to entreat thee well in the time of evil and in the time of affliction.* The LORD said, "Surely I will free You for a good purpose. Surely I will make Your enemies plead with You in times of disaster and distress.
- 12 *Shall iron break the northern iron and the steel?* Can a man break iron — iron from the north — or bronze?
- 13 *Thy substance and thy treasures will I give to the spoil without price, and that for all thy sins, even in all thy borders.* Your wealth and Your treasures I will give as plunder without charge — because of all Your sins throughout Your country.
- 14 *And I will make thee to pass with thine enemies into a land which thou knowest not: for a fire is kindled in mine anger, which shall burn upon you.* I will enslave You to Your enemies in a land You do not know, for My anger has kindled a fire that will burn against You."
- 15 *O LORD, thou knowest: remember me, and visit me, and revenge me of my persecutors; take me not away in thy longsuffering: know that for thy sake I have suffered rebuke.* LORD, You understand. Remember me and care for me. Avenge me on my persecutors. You are longsuffering — do not take me away. Know that for Your sake I suffer reproach.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — "patient endurance in the face of difficulty or provocation; God's slowness to anger and willingness to withhold punishment far longer than anyone deserves."

- 16 *Thy words were found, and I did eat them; and thy word was unto me the joy and rejoicing of mine heart: for I am called by thy name, O LORD God of hosts.* When Your words came, I received them joyfully. Your word was the joy and delight of my heart, for I bear Your name, LORD God of hosts.
- 17 *I sat not in the assembly of the mockers, nor rejoiced; I sat alone because of thy hand: for thou hast filled me with indignation.* I did not sit in the company of mockers or celebrate with them. Under Your hand I sat alone, because You had filled me with indignation.

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| <p>18 <i>Why is my pain perpetual, and my wound incurable, which refuseth to be healed? wilt thou be altogether unto me as a liar, and as waters that fail?</i></p> <p>19 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD, If thou return, then will I bring thee again, and thou shalt stand before me: and if thou take forth the precious from the vile, thou shalt be as my mouth: let them return unto thee; but return not thou unto them.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And I will make thee unto this people a fenced brasen wall: and they shall fight against thee, but they shall not prevail against thee: for I am with thee to save thee and to deliver thee, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And I will deliver thee out of the hand of the wicked, and I will redeem thee out of the hand of the terrible.</i></p> | <p>Why is my pain unending and my wound grievous and incurable? Will You be to me like a deceptive brook, like a spring that fails?</p> <p>Therefore this is what the LORD says: "If You return, I will restore You and You will stand before Me. If You speak what is precious rather than what is worthless, You will be My spokesman. Let them turn to You — but do not turn to them.</p> <p>I will make You a strong bronze wall to this people. They will fight against You but will not overcome You, for I am with You to rescue and save You," says the LORD.</p> <p>"I will save you from the hands of the wicked and rescue you from the hands of the ruthless."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Samuel (*SAM-yoo-el*) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 14:14; Ezek 14:20-21; Jer 14:11; Jer 11:14; Ps 106:23
- v2 — Jer 43:11; Zech 11:9; Rev 13:10; Rev 6:3-8; Ezek 5:2
- v3 — Deut 28:26; Lev 26:16; Lev 26:22; Rev 6:8; Ezek 14:21
- v4 — Jer 24:9; 2 Kgs 24:3-4; 2 Kgs 23:26-27; 2 Kgs 21:16-17; 2 Kgs 21:11-13
- v7 — Matt 3:12; Jer 51:2; Isa 41:16; Jer 5:3; Isa 9:13

v11 — Prov 16:7; Jer 29:11-14; Ps 106:46; Ps 37:3-11; Eccl 8:12

v13 — Jer 17:3; Ps 44:12; Isa 52:3

v15 — Ps 69:7-9; Jer 12:3; Luke 21:17; Neh 13:22; Jer 17:16

v16 — Rev 10:9-10; Ezek 3:1-3; Ps 119:101-103; Job 23:12; Ps 19:10

v19 — Zech 3:7; Luke 21:15; Lev 10:10; Ezek 44:23; Ezek 22:26

v20 — Jer 1:18-19; Ezek 3:9; Ps 46:7; Acts 18:9-10; Ps 124:1-3

v21 — 2 Cor 1:10; Isa 49:24-25; Jer 50:34; Isa 54:17; Isa 29:20

Chapter 16

The LORD commanded Jeremiah not to take a wife or have children in this place, because sons and daughters born there would die of deadly diseases. He was not to enter a house of mourning or a house of feasting, for the LORD had taken away His peace, lovingkindness, and mercies from this people. Yet afterward the LORD would bring them back from all the lands where He had driven them.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD came also unto me, saying,</i> | <i>The word of the LORD came to me:</i> |
| 2 | <i>Thou shalt not take thee a wife, neither shalt thou have sons or daughters in this place.</i> | <i>"You must not marry or have sons or daughters in this place."</i> |
| 3 | <i>For thus saith the LORD concerning the sons and concerning the daughters that are born in this place, and concerning their mothers that bare them, and concerning their fathers that begat them in this land;</i> | <i>For this is what the LORD says about the sons and daughters born in this land and about the mothers who bear them and the fathers who father them:</i> |
| 4 | <i>They shall die of grievous deaths; they shall not be lamented; neither shall they be buried; but they shall be as dung upon the face of the earth: and they shall be consumed by the sword, and by famine; and their carcasses shall be meat for the fowls of heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.</i> | <i>"They will die of deadly diseases. They will not be mourned or buried but will lie like dung on the surface of the ground. They will perish by sword and famine. Their bodies will become food for the birds of the air and the wild animals."</i> |

- 5 *For thus saith the LORD, Enter not into the house of mourning, neither go to lament nor bemoan them: for I have taken away my peace from this people, saith the LORD, even lovingkindness and mercies.* For this is what the LORD says: "Do not enter a house where there is a funeral meal. Do not go to mourn or show sympathy, because I have withdrawn My blessing, My mercy, and My compassion from this people," says the LORD.
- 6 *Both the great and the small shall die in this land: they shall not be buried, neither shall men lament for them, nor cut themselves, nor make themselves bald for them:* "Both high and low will die in this land. They will not be buried or mourned. No one will cut themselves or shave their head for them.
- 7 *Neither shall men tear themselves for them in mourning, to comfort them for the dead; neither shall men give them the cup of consolation to drink for their father or for their mother.* No one will offer food to comfort those who mourn for the dead — not even for a father or a mother. No one will give them a drink to console them.
- 8 *Thou shalt not also go into the house of feasting, to sit with them to eat and to drink.* "And do not enter a house where people are feasting and sit down with them to eat and drink.
- 9 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will cause to cease out of this place in your eyes, and in your days, the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride.* For this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: I am going to put an end to the sounds of joy and gladness and the voices of the bride and groom in this place — in Your own lifetime and before Your eyes.
- 10 *And it shall come to pass, when thou shalt shew this people all these words, and they shall say unto thee, Wherefore hath the LORD pronounced all this great evil against us? or what is our iniquity? or what is our sin that we have committed against the LORD our God?* When You tell these people all this and they ask You, 'Why has the LORD decreed such great disaster against us? What wrong have we done? What sin have we committed against the LORD our God?'

- 11 *Then shalt thou say unto them, Because your fathers have forsaken me, saith the LORD, and have walked after other gods, and have served them, and have worshipped them, and have forsaken me, and have not kept my law;* then say to them, 'It is because Your ancestors forsook Me,' says the LORD, 'and followed other gods and served and worshiped them. They forsook Me and did not keep My law.
- 12 *And ye have done worse than your fathers; for, behold, ye walk every one after the imagination of his evil heart, that they may not hearken unto me:* And You have behaved worse than Your ancestors. Each of You follows the stubbornness of Your evil heart instead of obeying Me.
- 13 *Therefore will I cast you out of this land into a land that ye know not, neither ye nor your fathers; and there shall ye serve other gods day and night; where I will not shew you favour.* So I will throw You out of this land into a land neither You nor Your ancestors have known. There You will serve other gods day and night, for I will show You no favor.'
- 14 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that it shall no more be said, The LORD liveth, that brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;* "But the days are coming," says the LORD, "when people will no longer say, 'As the LORD lives, who brought the Israelites up out of Egypt,'
- 15 *But, The LORD liveth, that brought up the children of Israel from the land of the north, and from all the lands whither he had driven them: and I will bring them again into their land that I gave unto their fathers.* but they will say, 'As the LORD lives, who brought the Israelites up out of the land of the north and out of all the countries where He had driven them.' For I will restore them to the land I gave their ancestors.
- 16 *Behold, I will send for many fishers, saith the LORD, and they shall fish them; and after will I send for many hunters, and they shall hunt them from every mountain, and from every hill, and out of the holes of the rocks.* "But first I will send for many fishermen," says the LORD, "and they will catch them. After that I will send for many hunters, and they will hunt them down from every mountain and hill and from the crevices in the rocks.

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| <p>17 <i>For mine eyes are upon all their ways: they are not hid from my face, neither is their iniquity hid from mine eyes.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And first I will recompense their iniquity and their sin double; because they have defiled my land, they have filled mine inheritance with the carcases of their detestable and abominable things.</i></p> <p>19 <i>O LORD, my strength, and my fortress, and my refuge in the day of affliction, the Gentiles shall come unto thee from the ends of the earth, and shall say, Surely our fathers have inherited lies, vanity, and things wherein there is no profit.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Shall a man make gods unto himself, and they are no gods?</i></p> <p>21 <i>Therefore, behold, I will this once cause them to know, I will cause them to know mine hand and my might; and they shall know that my name is The LORD.</i></p> | <p>My eyes are on all their ways. They are not hidden from Me, nor is their iniquity hidden from My eyes.</p> <p>I will repay them double for their wickedness and their sin, because they have defiled My land with the lifeless forms of their vile images and filled My inheritance with their detestable idols."</p> <p>LORD, my strength and my fortress, my refuge in the day of distress — the nations will come to you from the ends of the earth and say, "Our ancestors inherited nothing but lies, worthless things with no benefit."</p> <p>Can people make their own gods? Such things are not gods at all!</p> <p>"Therefore I will teach them — this time I will teach them My power and My strength. They will know that My name is the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Jer 25:33; Ps 83:10; Jer 9:22
 v5 — Ezek 24:16-23; Isa 27:11
 v6 — Deut 14:1; Jer 47:5; Jer 41:5
 v9 — Jer 7:34; Ezek 26:13; Hos 2:11; Jer 25:10
 v12 — Jer 7:26; Jer 13:10
 v13 — Deut 28:36; Deut 4:26-28; Jer 15:14; Jer 17:4; 2 Chr 7:20
 v14 — Jer 23:7-8; Ex 20:2; Deut 15:15
 v15 — Jer 32:37; Jer 3:18; Jer 24:6
 v16 — Hab 1:14-15; Amos 4:2; Mic 7:2; Rev 6:15-17
 v17 — Prov 15:3; Prov 5:21; Jer 23:24; Ps 90:8; Job 34:21-22
 v19 — Isa 25:4; Nah 1:7; Isa 2:2-3; Jer 17:17
 v21 — Ps 9:16; Ps 83:18; Jer 33:2

Chapter 17

The LORD declared that the sin of Judah was written with a pen of iron and engraved on the tablet of their heart. Cursed is the man who trusts in man, but blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, for he shall be like a tree planted by the waters. The heart is deceitful above all things and desperately wicked -- who can know it? The LORD searches the heart and tests the mind.

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| <p>1 <i>The sin of Judah is written with a pen of iron, and with the point of a diamond: it is graven upon the table of their heart, and upon the horns of your altars;</i></p> | <p>"The sin of Judah is engraved with an iron tool — inscribed with a flint point on the tablet of their hearts and on the horns of their altars.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Whilst their children remember their altars and their groves by the green trees upon the high hills.</i></p> | <p>Even their children remember their altars and their groves by the green trees upon the high hills.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>O my mountain in the field, I will give thy substance and all thy treasures to the spoil, and thy high places for sin, throughout all thy borders.</i></p> | <p>My mountain in the open country — I will give away Your wealth and all Your treasures as plunder, along with Your high places, because of sin throughout Your land.</p> |

- 4 *And thou, even thyself, shalt discontinue from thine heritage that I gave thee; and I will cause thee to serve thine enemies in the land which thou knowest not: for ye have kindled a fire in mine anger, which shall burn for ever.* You will lose the inheritance I gave You. I will enslave You to Your enemies in a land You do not know, for You have kindled My anger, and it will burn forever."
- 5 *Thus saith the LORD; Cursed be the man that trusteth in man, and maketh flesh his arm, and whose heart departeth from the LORD.* This is what the LORD says: "Cursed is the one who trusts in man — who depends on human strength and whose heart turns away from the LORD.
- 6 *For he shall be like the heath in the desert, and shall not see when good cometh; but shall inhabit the parched places in the wilderness, in a salt land and not inhabited.* That person will be like a bush in the desert. They will not see prosperity when it comes. They will live in the parched wilderness, in a salt land where no one lives.
- 7 *Blessed is the man that trusteth in the LORD, and whose hope the LORD is.* But blessed is the one who trusts in the LORD, whose hope is in the LORD.
- 8 *For he shall be as a tree planted by the waters, and that spreadeth out her roots by the river, and shall not see when heat cometh, but her leaf shall be green; and shall not be careful in the year of drought, neither shall cease from yielding fruit.* That person is like a tree planted by the water. It sends out its roots by the stream and does not fear when heat comes. Its leaves stay green. It has no worries in a year of drought and never fails to bear fruit.
- 9 *The heart is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked: who can know it?* The heart is more deceitful than anything else and desperately wicked. Who can understand it?
- 10 *I the LORD search the heart, I try the reins, even to give every man according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings.* I the LORD search the heart and test the mind, to reward each person according to their conduct — according to what their deeds deserve.

- 11 *As the partridge sitteth on eggs, and hatcheth them not; so he that getteth riches, and not by right, shall leave them in the midst of his days, and at his end shall be a fool.* Like a partridge that hatches eggs it did not lay is the person who gains riches by unjust means. When their life is half gone, their riches will desert them. In the end they will be shown to be a fool.
- 12 *A glorious high throne from the beginning is the place of our sanctuary.* A glorious throne, exalted from the beginning — that is the place of our sanctuary.
- 13 *O LORD, the hope of Israel, all that forsake thee shall be ashamed, and they that depart from me shall be written in the earth, because they have forsaken the LORD, the fountain of living waters.* LORD, You are the hope of Israel. All who forsake You will be put to shame. Those who turn away from You will be written in the dust, for they have forsaken the LORD, the spring of living water.
- 14 *Heal me, O LORD, and I shall be healed; save me, and I shall be saved: for thou art my praise.* Heal me, LORD, and I will be healed. Save me and I will be saved, for You are the one I praise.
- 15 *Behold, they say unto me, Where is the word of the LORD? let it come now.* They keep saying to me, "Where is the word of the LORD? Let it come now!"
- 16 *As for me, I have not hastened from being a pastor to follow thee: neither have I desired the woeful day; thou knowest: that which came out of my lips was right before thee.* I have not run away from being Your shepherd. I have not desired the day of disaster. You know what passed my lips was said in Your presence.
- 17 *Be not a terror unto me: thou art my hope in the day of evil.* Do not be a terror to me. You are my refuge in the day of disaster.
- 18 *Let them be confounded that persecute me, but let not me be confounded: let them be dismayed, but let not me be dismayed: bring upon them the day of evil, and destroy them with double destruction.* Let those who persecute me be put to shame, but keep me from shame. Let them be terrified, but keep me from terror. Bring on them the day of disaster — destroy them with double destruction.

- 19 *Thus said the LORD unto me; Go and stand in the gate of the children of the people, whereby the kings of Judah come in, and by the which they go out, and in all the gates of Jerusalem;* This is what the LORD said to me: "Go and stand at the Gate of the People, through which the kings of Judah come and go. Then stand at all the other gates of Jerusalem.
- 20 *And say unto them, Hear ye the word of the LORD, ye kings of Judah, and all Judah, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, that enter in by these gates:* Say to them: 'Hear the word of the LORD, You kings of Judah and all people of Judah and everyone who comes through these gates.
- 21 *Thus saith the LORD; Take heed to yourselves, and bear no burden on the sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of Jerusalem;* This is what the LORD says: Be careful not to carry a load on the Sabbath day or bring it through the gates of Jerusalem.
- 22 *Neither carry forth a burden out of your houses on the sabbath day, neither do ye any work, but hallow ye the sabbath day, as I commanded your fathers.* Do not carry a load out of Your houses or do any work on the Sabbath, but keep the Sabbath day holy, as I commanded Your ancestors.
- 23 *But they obeyed not, neither inclined their ear, but made their neck stiff, that they might not hear, nor receive instruction.* Yet they did not listen or pay attention. They were stiff-necked and would not listen or accept correction.
- 24 *And it shall come to pass, if ye diligently hearken unto me, saith the LORD, to bring in no burden through the gates of this city on the sabbath day, but hallow the sabbath day, to do no work therein;* But if You are careful to obey Me," says the LORD, "and bring no load through the gates of this city on the Sabbath, but keep the Sabbath day holy by not doing any work on it —

- 25 *Then shall there enter into the gates of this city kings and princes sitting upon the throne of David, riding in chariots and on horses, they, and their princes, the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem: and this city shall remain for ever.* then kings who sit on David's throne will come through the gates of this city with their officials — in chariots and on horses. The people of Judah and Jerusalem will come, and this city will be inhabited forever.
- 26 *And they shall come from the cities of Judah, and from the places about Jerusalem, and from the land of Benjamin, and from the plain, and from the mountains, and from the south, bringing burnt offerings, and sacrifices, and meat offerings, and incense, and bringing sacrifices of praise, unto the house of the LORD.* People will come from the cities of Judah and from the places about Jerusalem, from the land of Benjamin and from the plain, and from the mountains, and from the south, bringing burnt offerings and sacrifices, meat offerings and incense, and sacrifices of praise to the house of the LORD.
- 27 *But if ye will not hearken unto me to hallow the sabbath day, and not to bear a burden, even entering in at the gates of Jerusalem on the sabbath day; then will I kindle a fire in the gates thereof, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem, and it shall not be quenched.* But if You do not listen to Me and keep the Sabbath day holy — if You carry loads through the gates of Jerusalem on the Sabbath — then I will set fire to its gates. It will consume the palaces of Jerusalem and will not be quenched."

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

v1 — Prov 3:3; 2 Cor 3:3; Prov 7:3; Lev 4:25; Job 19:23-24

v4 — Jer 15:14; Lam 5:2; Isa 5:25; Mark 9:43-49; Jer 7:20

v5 — Ps 118:8-9; Ps 146:3-4; Isa 2:22; 2 Chr 32:8; Isa 31:1-9

v7 — Isa 26:3-4; Ps 34:8; Ps 40:4; Ps 125:1; Isa 30:18

v8 — Ps 1:3; Isa 58:11; Ezek 47:12; Ezek 31:4-10; Ps 92:10-15

v9 — Mark 7:21-22; Matt 15:19; Eccl 9:3; Prov 28:26; Heb 3:12
v10 — 1 Sam 16:7; Rom 8:27; Jer 11:20; Heb 4:12-13; Rev 2:23
v11 — Prov 28:20; Prov 21:6; Jer 22:17; Jer 22:13; Prov 15:27
v12 — Ps 96:6; Jer 3:17; Ezek 43:7; Jer 14:21; Ezek 1:26
v13 — Rev 7:17; John 4:14; John 7:37-38; Rev 22:1; John 4:10
v14 — Ps 6:2; Deut 32:39; Ps 106:47; Luke 4:18; Ps 6:4
v17 — Nah 1:7; Jer 16:19; Ps 59:16; Ps 88:15-16; Job 31:23

Chapter 18

The LORD sent Jeremiah to the potter's house, where the potter reworked a marred vessel into another vessel as it pleased him. As the clay is in the potter's hand, so is Israel in the LORD's hand -- He can pluck up or build a nation as He chooses. The people plotted against Jeremiah, and he prayed for the LORD to deal with them in the time of His anger.

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| 1 <i>The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,</i> | This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD: |
| 2 <i>Arise, and go down to the potter's house, and there I will cause thee to hear my words.</i> | "Go down to the potter's house, and there I will give You My message." |
| 3 <i>Then I went down to the potter's house, and, behold, he wrought a work on the wheels.</i> | So I went down to the potter's house, and I saw Him working at the wheel. |
| 4 <i>And the vessel that he made of clay was marred in the hand of the potter: so he made it again another vessel, as seemed good to the potter to make it.</i> | But the pot He was shaping from the clay was ruined in His hands. So the potter formed it into another pot, shaping it as seemed best to Him. |
| 5 <i>Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying,</i> | Then the word of the LORD came to me: |
| 6 <i>O house of Israel, cannot I do with you as this potter? saith the LORD. Behold, as the clay is in the potter's hand, so are ye in mine hand, O house of Israel.</i> | "Can I not do with You, Israel, as this potter does?" says the LORD. "Like clay in the hand of the potter, so are You in My hand, Israel. |
| 7 <i>At what instant I shall speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to pluck up, and to pull down, and to destroy it;</i> | If at any time I announce that a nation or kingdom is to be uprooted, torn down, and destroyed, |

- 8 *If that nation, against whom I have pronounced, turn from their evil, I will repent of the evil that I thought to do unto them.* and if that nation I warned repents of its evil, then I will relent and not bring on it the disaster I had planned.
- 9 *And at what instant I shall speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to build and to plant it;* And if at another time I announce that a nation or kingdom is to be built up and planted,
- 10 *If it do evil in my sight, that it obey not my voice, then I will repent of the good, wherewith I said I would benefit them.* and if it does evil in My sight and does not obey Me, then I will reconsider the good I had intended to do for it.
- 11 *Now therefore go to, speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I am framing evil against you, and devising a device against you: return ye now every one from his evil way, and make your ways and your doings good.* Now therefore say to the people of Judah and those who live in Jerusalem, 'This is what the LORD says: Look — I am preparing a disaster for You and devising a plan against You. Turn from Your evil ways, each of You, and reform Your ways and Your actions.'
- 12 *And they said, There is no hope: but we will walk after our own devices, and we will every one do the imagination of his evil heart.* But they will reply, 'It is no use. We will continue with our own plans. Each of us will follow the stubbornness of our evil heart.'
- 13 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; Ask ye now among the heathen, who hath heard such things: the virgin of Israel hath done a very horrible thing.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: "Ask the nations: Has anyone heard anything like this? A most horrible thing has been done by Virgin Israel.
- 14 *Will a man leave the snow of Lebanon which cometh from the rock of the field? or shall the cold flowing waters that come from another place be forsaken?* Does the snow of Lebanon ever vanish from its rocky slopes? Do its cool waters from distant sources ever stop flowing?

- 15 *Because my people hath forgotten me, they have burned incense to vanity, and they have caused them to stumble in their ways from the ancient paths, to walk in paths, in a way not cast up;* Yet My people have forgotten Me. They burn incense to worthless idols. They have stumbled off the ancient paths and walk on byways — roads not built up.
- 16 *To make their land desolate, and a perpetual hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished, and wag his head.* Their land will be laid waste — an object of lasting scorn. All who pass by will be appalled and will shake their heads.
- 17 *I will scatter them as with an east wind before the enemy; I will shew them the back, and not the face, in the day of their calamity.* Like a wind from the east, I will scatter them before their enemies. I will show them My back and not My face in the day of their disaster."
- 18 *Then said they, Come, and let us devise devices against Jeremiah; for the law shall not perish from the priest, nor counsel from the wise, nor the word from the prophet. Come, and let us smite him with the tongue, and let us not give heed to any of his words.* They said, "Come, let us make plans against Jeremiah. Surely the teaching of the law by the priest will not cease, nor will counsel from the wise, nor the word from the prophets. Come, let us attack him with our tongues and pay no attention to anything he says."
- 19 *Give heed to me, O LORD, and hearken to the voice of them that contend with me.* Listen to me, LORD. Hear what my accusers are saying.
- 20 *Shall evil be recompensed for good? for they have digged a pit for my soul. Remember that I stood before thee to speak good for them, and to turn away thy wrath from them.* Should good be repaid with evil? Yet they have dug a pit for me. Remember that I stood before You and spoke on their behalf to turn Your wrath away from them.

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| <p>21 <i>Therefore deliver up their children to the famine, and pour out their blood by the force of the sword; and let their wives be bereaved of their children, and be widows; and let their men be put to death; let their young men be slain by the sword in battle.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Let a cry be heard from their houses, when thou shalt bring a troop suddenly upon them: for they have digged a pit to take me, and hid snares for my feet.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Yet, LORD, thou knowest all their counsel against me to slay me: forgive not their iniquity, neither blot out their sin from thy sight, but let them be overthrown before thee; deal thus with them in the time of thine anger.</i></p> | <p>So give their children over to famine. Hand them over to the power of the sword. Let their wives be made childless and widows. Let their men be killed and their young men struck down by the sword in battle.</p> <p>Let a cry be heard from their houses when You suddenly bring raiders against them — for they have dug a pit to capture me and have hidden snares for my feet.</p> <p>But You, LORD, know all their plots to kill me. Do not forgive their iniquity or blot out their sins from Your sight. Let them be overthrown before You. Deal with them in the time of Your anger.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v4 — Rom 9:20-23; Jer 18:6; Isa 45:9

v6 — Isa 64:8; Rom 9:20-21; Jer 18:4; Isa 45:9; Matt 20:15

v8 — Ezek 18:21; Jer 26:13; Jonah 3:9-10; Hos 11:8; Jer 26:3

v9 — Jer 31:28; Amos 9:11-15

v10 — Ezek 33:18; 1 Sam 2:30; Ezek 18:24; 1 Sam 13:13

v11 — 2 Kgs 17:13; Isa 55:6-7; Jer 35:15; Jer 7:3; Isa 1:16-19

v12 — Jer 2:25; Jer 16:12; Deut 29:19; Jer 7:24

v15 — Jer 6:16; Jer 2:32; Isa 57:14; Hos 11:2; Jer 2:13

v16 — Ps 22:7; Jer 25:9; Jer 19:8

v17 — Jer 13:24; Jer 2:27

v18 — Ps 52:2; Jer 11:19; Mal 2:7; Jer 18:11

v20 — Ps 35:7; Ps 57:6; Ps 106:23; 1 Sam 24:17-19; Ps 35:12

Chapter 19

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to buy a potter's earthen bottle and go to the Valley of the Son of Hinnom. He prophesied that the valley would be called the Valley of Slaughter because of the innocent blood shed there. Jeremiah broke the bottle before the elders as a sign that the LORD would break Jerusalem and her people beyond repair.

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| <p>1 <i>Thus saith the LORD, Go and get a potter's earthen bottle, and take of the ancients of the people, and of the ancients of the priests;</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD said: "Go and buy a clay jar from a potter. Take along some of the elders of the people and some of the leading priests.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And go forth unto the valley of the son of Hinnom, which is by the entry of the east gate, and proclaim there the words that I shall tell thee,</i></p> | <p>Go out to the Valley of Ben Hinnom, near the entrance of the Potsherd Gate. Proclaim there the words I tell You.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And say, Hear ye the word of the LORD, O kings of Judah, and inhabitants of Jerusalem; Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, the which whosoever heareth, his ears shall tingle.</i></p> | <p>Say, 'Hear the word of the LORD, You kings of Judah and people of Jerusalem. This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: I am going to bring a disaster on this place that will make the ears of everyone who hears of it ring.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Because they have forsaken me, and have estranged this place, and have burned incense in it unto other gods, whom neither they nor their fathers have known, nor the kings of Judah, and have filled this place with the blood of innocents;</i></p> | <p>For they have forsaken Me and made this a foreign place. They have burned incense here to other gods that neither they nor their ancestors nor the kings of Judah ever knew. They have filled this place with the blood of the innocent.</p> |

- 5 *They have built also the high places of Baal, to burn their sons with fire for burnt offerings unto Baal, which I commanded not, nor spake it, neither came it into my mind:* They have built the high places of Baal to burn their children in the fire as offerings to Baal — something I did not command or mention, nor did it enter My mind.
- 6 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that this place shall no more be called Tophet, nor The valley of the son of Hinnom, but The valley of slaughter.* So the days are coming,' says the LORD, 'when people will no longer call this place Topheth or the Valley of Ben Hinnom, but the Valley of Slaughter.
- 7 *And I will make void the counsel of Judah and Jerusalem in this place; and I will cause them to fall by the sword before their enemies, and by the hands of them that seek their lives: and their carcasses will I give to be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.* In this place I will ruin the plans of Judah and Jerusalem. I will make them fall by the sword before their enemies — at the hands of those who want to kill them. I will give their bodies as food for the birds of the air and the wild animals.
- 8 *And I will make this city desolate, and an hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished and hiss because of all the plagues thereof.* I will devastate this city and make it an object of scorn. Everyone who passes by will be appalled and will scoff at all its wounds.
- 9 *And I will cause them to eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters, and they shall eat every one the flesh of his friend in the siege and straitness, wherewith their enemies, and they that seek their lives, shall straiten them.* I will make them eat the flesh of their sons and daughters. They will eat each other's flesh during the siege — the distress their enemies will inflict on them as they try to destroy them.'
- 10 *Then shalt thou break the bottle in the sight of the men that go with thee,* Then break the jar in front of the men who went with You

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| <p>11 <i>And shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Even so will I break this people and this city, as one breaketh a potter's vessel, that cannot be made whole again: and they shall bury them in Tophet, till there be no place to bury.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Thus will I do unto this place, saith the LORD, and to the inhabitants thereof, and even make this city as Tophet:</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the houses of Jerusalem, and the houses of the kings of Judah, shall be defiled as the place of Tophet, because of all the houses upon whose roofs they have burned incense unto all the host of heaven, and have poured out drink offerings unto other gods.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then came Jeremiah from Tophet, whither the LORD had sent him to prophesy; and he stood in the court of the LORD's house; and said to all the people,</i></p> <p>15 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring upon this city and upon all her towns all the evil that I have pronounced against it, because they have hardened their necks, that they might not hear my words.</i></p> | <p>and say to them, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: I will smash this nation and this city just as this potter's jar is smashed and cannot be repaired. They will bury the dead in Topheth until there is no room to bury anyone.'</p> <p>This is what I will do to this place and to those who live here," says the LORD. "I will make this city like Topheth.</p> <p>The houses of Jerusalem and the houses of the kings of Judah will be defiled like this place of Topheth — all the houses where they burned incense on the rooftops to all the starry hosts and poured out drink offerings to other gods."</p> <p>Jeremiah then returned from Topheth, where the LORD had sent Him to prophesy, and He stood in the court of the LORD's house and said to all the people:</p> <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I am going to bring on this city and on all the villages around it every disaster I pronounced against them, because they were stiff-necked and would not listen to My words.'"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Josh 15:8

v3 — 1 Sam 3:11; Jer 17:20

v4 — Jer 2:34; Isa 65:11; Deut 28:20; 2 Kgs 21:16

v5 — Jer 32:35; Deut 12:31; Ps 106:37-38; Lev 18:21; Jer 7:31-32

v7 — Lev 26:17

v8 — Jer 18:16

v9 — Isa 9:20; Lev 26:29; Lam 4:10

v11 — Ps 2:9; Isa 30:14

v13 — 2 Kgs 23:12; Jer 32:29; Jer 7:18; Zeph 1:5

v14 — Jer 26:2; 2 Chr 20:5

v15 — Jer 7:26; Jer 17:23

Chapter 20

Pashur the priest, chief governor of the temple, struck Jeremiah and put him in stocks. When released, Jeremiah renamed Pashur 'Magorissabib' -- terror on every side -- and prophesied that all Judah would be given to the king of Babylon. Jeremiah cursed the day he was born, crying that the word of the LORD had made him a reproach, yet it burned in his heart like fire and he could not hold it in.

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| 1 | <i>Now Pashur the son of Immer the priest, who was also chief governor in the house of the LORD, heard that Jeremiah prophesied these things.</i> | Now Pashhur son of Immer, the priest who was chief officer in the temple of the LORD, heard Jeremiah prophesying these things. |
| 2 | <i>Then Pashur smote Jeremiah the prophet, and put him in the stocks that were in the high gate of Benjamin, which was by the house of the LORD.</i> | So Pashhur had Jeremiah the prophet beaten and put in the stocks at the Upper Gate of Benjamin in the LORD's temple. |

- 3 *And it came to pass on the morrow, that Pashur brought forth Jeremiah out of the stocks. Then said Jeremiah unto him, The LORD hath not called thy name Pashur, but Magorissabib.* The next day, when Pashhur released Jeremiah from the stocks, Jeremiah said to him, "The LORD's name for You is not Pashhur but 'Terror on Every Side.'
- 4 *For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will make thee a terror to thyself, and to all thy friends: and they shall fall by the sword of their enemies, and thine eyes shall behold it: and I will give all Judah into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall carry them captive into Babylon, and shall slay them with the sword.* For this is what the LORD says: 'I will make You a terror to Yourself and to all Your friends. You will watch them fall by the sword of their enemies. I will hand all Judah over to the king of Babylon, who will carry them away to Babylon or put them to the sword.
- 5 *Moreover I will deliver all the strength of this city, and all the labours thereof, and all the precious things thereof, and all the treasures of the kings of Judah will I give into the hand of their enemies, which shall spoil them, and take them, and carry them to Babylon.* I will hand over to their enemies all the wealth of this city — all its produce and all its valuables, and all the treasures of the kings of Judah. They will take it all to Babylon as plunder.
- 6 *And thou, Pashur, and all that dwell in thine house shall go into captivity: and thou shalt come to Babylon, and there thou shalt die, and shalt be buried there, thou, and all thy friends, to whom thou hast prophesied lies.* And You, Pashhur, and all who live in Your house will go into exile to Babylon. There You will die and be buried — you and all Your friends to whom You have prophesied lies."
- 7 *O LORD, thou hast deceived me, and I was deceived: thou art stronger than I, and hast prevailed: I am in derision daily, every one mocketh me.* LORD, You deceived me and I was deceived. You overpowered me and prevailed. I am ridiculed all day long — everyone mocks me.

- 8 *For since I spake, I cried out, I cried violence and spoil; because the word of the LORD was made a reproach unto me, and a derision, daily.* Whenever I speak, I cry out proclaiming violence and destruction. So the word of the LORD has brought me insult and reproach all day long.
- 9 *Then I said, I will not make mention of him, nor speak any more in his name. But his word was in mine heart as a burning fire shut up in my bones, and I was weary with forbearing, and I could not stay.* But if I say, "I will not mention His word or speak anymore in His name," His word burns in my heart like a fire — a fire shut up in my bones. I am weary of holding it in. Indeed, I cannot.
- 10 *For I heard the defaming of many, fear on every side. Report, say they, and we will report it. All my familiars watched for my halting, saying, Peradventure he will be enticed, and we shall prevail against him, and we shall take our revenge on him.* I hear many whispering, "Terror on every side! Report Him! Let's report Him!" All my closest friends are waiting for me to slip. They say, "Perhaps He will be deceived, and then we can overpower Him and take our revenge."
- 11 *But the LORD is with me as a mighty terrible one: therefore my persecutors shall stumble, and they shall not prevail: they shall be greatly ashamed; for they shall not prosper: their everlasting confusion shall never be forgotten.* But the LORD is with me like a mighty warrior. So my persecutors will stumble and will not prevail. They will fail and be thoroughly ashamed — their dishonor will never be forgotten.
- 12 *But, O LORD of hosts, that triest the righteous, and seest the reins and the heart, let me see thy vengeance on them: for unto thee have I opened my cause.* LORD of hosts, You who test the righteous and see the heart and mind — let me see Your vengeance on them, for to You I have committed my cause.
- 13 *Sing unto the LORD, praise ye the LORD: for he hath delivered the soul of the poor from the hand of evildoers.* Sing to the LORD! Praise the LORD! For He has rescued the life of the needy from the hands of the wicked.
- 14 *Cursed be the day wherein I was born: let not the day wherein my mother bare me be blessed.* Cursed be the day I was born! May the day my mother gave birth to me not be blessed!

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| <p>15 <i>Cursed be the man who brought tidings to my father, saying, A man child is born unto thee; making him very glad.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And let that man be as the cities which the LORD overthrew, and repented not: and let him hear the cry in the morning, and the shouting at noontide;</i></p> <p>17 <i>Because he slew me not from the womb; or that my mother might have been my grave, and her womb to be always great with me.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Wherefore came I forth out of the womb to see labour and sorrow, that my days should be consumed with shame?</i></p> | <p>Cursed be the man who brought my father the news, "A son is born to you!" — making him very glad.</p> <p>May that man be like the towns the LORD overthrew without pity. May He hear wailing in the morning and battle cries at noon.</p> <p>For He did not kill me in the womb — he who let my mother be my grave, her womb enlarged forever.</p> <p>Why did I ever come out of the womb to see trouble and sorrow and to end my days in shame?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezra 2:37-38; 1 Chr 24:14
- v4 — Jer 29:21; Jer 25:9
- v6 — Jer 14:14-15; Lam 2:14
- v7 — Lam 3:14; Jer 20:9; Hos 9:7
- v8 — Jer 6:10; 2 Chr 36:16
- v9 — Ps 39:3; Job 32:18-20; Acts 4:20; 1 Cor 9:16-17; Ezek 3:14
- v10 — Ps 41:9; Ps 31:13; Isa 29:21; Jer 18:18
- v11 — Jer 1:19; Jer 1:8; Jer 15:20; Isa 41:10; Jer 17:18
- v12 — Jer 11:20; Ps 62:8; Ps 54:7; Jer 17:10; Ps 59:10
- v13 — Isa 25:4; Ps 69:33; Ps 35:9-11
- v14 — Jer 15:10
- v17 — Job 3:10-11; Job 10:18-19

Chapter 21

King Zedekiah sent to Jeremiah to inquire of the LORD when Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem. The LORD answered that He Himself would fight against Judah with an outstretched hand and would deliver Zedekiah into Nebuchadnezzar's hand. He set before the people the way of life and the way of death -- whoever surrendered to the Chaldeans would live.

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| <p>1 <i>The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, when king Zedekiah sent unto him Pashur the son of Melchiah, and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest, saying,</i></p> | <p>This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD when King Zedekiah sent to him Pashhur son of Malkijah and the priest Zephaniah son of Maaseiah. They said:</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zedekiah** (zed-uh-KY-uh) — "the LORD is righteous" — the last king of Judah, installed by Nebuchadnezzar. He reigned from 597–586 BC when Jerusalem fell.

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| <p>2 <i>Enquire, I pray thee, of the LORD for us; for Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon maketh war against us; if so be that the LORD will deal with us according to all his wondrous works, that he may go up from us.</i></p> | <p>"Please ask the LORD for us, because Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon is attacking us. Perhaps the LORD will perform miracles for us as He did in the past and make Him withdraw from us."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nebuchadnezzar** (neb-uh-kud-NEZ-er) — "Nabu, protect my heir" — king of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem in 586 BC and took the people of Judah into exile.

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| <p>3 <i>Then said Jeremiah unto them, Thus shall ye say to Zedekiah:</i></p> | <p>Jeremiah answered them, "Tell Zedekiah:</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Thus saith the LORD God of Israel; Behold, I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands, wherewith ye fight against the king of Babylon, and against the Chaldeans, which besiege you without the walls, and I will assemble them into the midst of this city.</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: I am about to turn against You the weapons of war that are in Your hands — the ones You are using to fight the king of Babylon and the Babylonians who are outside the wall besieging You. I will bring those weapons into the center of this city.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, and in fury, and in great wrath.</i></p> | <p>I Myself will fight against You with outstretched hand and powerful arm — in anger, in fury, and in great wrath.</p> |

- 6 *And I will smite the inhabitants of this city, both man and beast: they shall die of a great pestilence.* I will strike the inhabitants of this city — both people and animals. They will die of a terrible plague.
- 7 *And afterward, saith the LORD, I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah, and his servants, and the people, and such as are left in this city from the pestilence, from the sword, and from the famine, into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of those that seek their life: and he shall smite them with the edge of the sword; he shall not spare them, neither have pity, nor have mercy.* After that,' says the LORD, 'I will hand over Zedekiah king of Judah, his officials, and the people of this city who survive the plague, the sword, and the famine, to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and to their enemies who seek their lives. He will strike them down with the sword — he will show them no mercy, pity, or compassion.'
- 8 *And unto this people thou shalt say, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I set before you the way of life, and the way of death.* Tell this people, 'This is what the LORD says: See, I am setting before You the way of life and the way of death.
- 9 *He that abideth in this city shall die by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence: but he that goeth out, and falleth to the Chaldeans that besiege you, he shall live, and his life shall be unto him for a prey.* Whoever stays in this city will die by sword, famine, or plague. But whoever goes out and surrenders to the Babylonians who are besieging You will live — their life will be spared.
- 10 *For I have set my face against this city for evil, and not for good, saith the LORD: it shall be given into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall burn it with fire.* I have determined to bring disaster on this city and not good,' says the LORD. 'It will be given into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will destroy it with fire.'
- 11 *And touching the house of the king of Judah, say, Hear ye the word of the LORD;* "To the royal house of Judah, say: 'Hear the word of the LORD.

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| <p>12 <i>O house of David, thus saith the LORD; Execute judgment in the morning, and deliver him that is spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor, lest my fury go out like fire, and burn that none can quench it, because of the evil of your doings.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Behold, I am against thee, O inhabitant of the valley, and rock of the plain, saith the LORD; which say, Who shall come down against us? or who shall enter into our habitations?</i></p> <p>14 <i>But I will punish you according to the fruit of your doings, saith the LORD: and I will kindle a fire in the forest thereof, and it shall devour all things round about it.</i></p> | <p>House of David, this is what the LORD says: Administer justice every morning. Rescue from the hand of the oppressor whoever has been robbed, or My anger will break out and burn like fire because of the evil You have done — burn with no one able to quench it.</p> <p>I am against You, Jerusalem, who live above this valley on the rocky plateau,' says the LORD. 'You say, "Who can attack us? Who can enter our stronghold?"</p> <p>I will punish You as Your deeds deserve,' says the LORD. 'I will kindle a fire in Your forests that will consume everything around You.'</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 29:25; Jer 37:3; Jer 52:24; Jer 38:1
- v2 — Jer 37:3
- v4 — Jer 33:5; Jer 32:5; Isa 13:4; Isa 5:5; Jer 37:8-10
- v5 — Isa 63:10; Jer 32:17; Isa 5:25; Ex 6:6
- v7 — Jer 37:17; 2 Kgs 25:5-7; Hab 1:6-10
- v8 — Deut 30:19; Deut 30:15; Deut 11:26; Isa 1:19-20
- v9 — Jer 38:2; Jer 39:18; Jer 45:5
- v10 — Jer 44:11; Amos 9:4; Jer 44:27; Jer 52:13; Ezek 15:7
- v11 — Jer 17:20
- v12 — Isa 1:17; Jer 4:4; Prov 31:8-9; Isa 1:31; Jer 22:2-3
- v13 — Lam 4:12; Obad 1:3-4; Ezek 13:8
- v14 — Isa 3:10-11; Jer 32:19; Prov 1:31

Chapter 22

The LORD sent Jeremiah to the king's house to demand justice and righteousness, warning that if they disobeyed, the palace would become a desolation. He pronounced judgment on Shallum, Jehoiakim, and Coniah, declaring that Coniah would be cast out and none of his descendants would prosper sitting on the throne of David.

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| <p>1 <i>Thus saith the LORD; Go down to the house of the king of Judah, and speak there this word,</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD says: "Go down to the palace of the king of Judah and proclaim this message there.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And say, Hear the word of the LORD, O king of Judah, that sittest upon the throne of David, thou, and thy servants, and thy people that enter in by these gates:</i></p> | <p>Say, 'Hear the word of the LORD, king of Judah, You who sit on David's throne — you, your officials, and your people who come through these gates.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Thus saith the LORD; Execute ye judgment and righteousness, and deliver the spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor: and do no wrong, do no violence to the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, neither shed innocent blood in this place.</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD says: Do what is just and right. Rescue from the hand of the oppressor those who have been robbed. Do no wrong or violence to the foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow. Do not shed innocent blood in this place.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For if ye do this thing indeed, then shall there enter in by the gates of this house kings sitting upon the throne of David, riding in chariots and on horses, he, and his servants, and his people.</i></p> | <p>If you are careful to carry out these commands, then kings who sit on David's throne will come through the gates of this palace, riding in chariots and on horses — they and their officials and their people.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>But if ye will not hear these words, I swear by myself, saith the LORD, that this house shall become a desolation.</i></p> | <p>But if You do not obey these commands, I swear by Myself,' says the LORD, 'that this palace will become a ruin.'"</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For thus saith the LORD unto the king's house of Judah; Thou art Gilead unto me, and the head of Lebanon: yet surely I will make thee a wilderness, and cities which are not inhabited.</i></p> | <p>For this is what the LORD says about the palace of the king of Judah: "Though you are like Gilead to Me, like the summit of Lebanon, I will surely make you a desert, like towns not inhabited.</p> |

- 7 *And I will prepare destroyers against thee, every one with his weapons: and they shall cut down thy choice cedars, and cast them into the fire.* I will send destroyers against You, each armed with weapons. They will cut down Your finest cedars and throw them into the fire.
- 8 *And many nations shall pass by this city, and they shall say every man to his neighbour, Wherefore hath the LORD done thus unto this great city?* People from many nations will pass by this city and ask one another, 'Why has the LORD done such a thing to this great city?'
- 9 *Then they shall answer, Because they have forsaken the covenant of the LORD their God, and worshipped other gods, and served them.* And the answer will be: 'Because they have forsaken the covenant of the LORD their God and have worshiped and served other gods.'
- 10 *Weep ye not for the dead, neither bemoan him: but weep sore for him that goeth away: for he shall return no more, nor see his native country.* Do not weep for the dead king or mourn for Him. Rather weep bitterly for the one who is exiled, because he will never return or see His native land again.
- 11 *For thus saith the LORD touching Shallum the son of Josiah king of Judah, which reigned instead of Josiah his father, which went forth out of this place; He shall not return thither any more:* For this is what the LORD says about Shallum son of Josiah, who succeeded his father Josiah as king of Judah but has gone from this place: "He will never return here.
- 12 *But he shall die in the place whither they have led him captive, and shall see this land no more.* He will die in the place where they have taken Him captive. He will not see this land again."
- 13 *Woe unto him that buildeth his house by unrighteousness, and his chambers by wrong; that useth his neighbour's service without wages, and giveth him not for his work;* "Woe to Him who builds His palace by unrighteous means and His upper rooms by injustice — who makes His neighbors work for nothing, paying them no wages.

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| <p>14 <i>That saith, I will build me a wide house and large chambers, and cutteth him out windows; and it is cieled with cedar, and painted with vermilion.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Shalt thou reign, because thou closest thyself in cedar? did not thy father eat and drink, and do judgment and justice, and then it was well with him?</i></p> <p>16 <i>He judged the cause of the poor and needy; then it was well with him: was not this to know me? saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But thine eyes and thine heart are not but for thy covetousness, and for to shed innocent blood, and for oppression, and for violence, to do it.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah; They shall not lament for him, saying, Ah my brother! or, Ah sister! they shall not lament for him, saying, Ah lord! or, Ah his glory!</i></p> | <p>He says, 'I will build myself a great palace with spacious upper rooms.' So He makes large windows in it, panels it with cedar and decorates it in red.</p> <p>Does it make You a king to have more and more cedar? Did not Your father eat and drink and do justice and what is right? Then things went well for Him.</p> <p>He defended the cause of the poor and needy. Then things went well. Is that not what it means to know Me?' says the LORD.</p> <p>But Your eyes and Your heart are set only on dishonest gain, on shedding innocent blood, on oppression and extortion."</p> <p>Therefore this is what the LORD says about Jehoiakim son of Josiah, king of Judah: "They will not mourn for him, saying, 'Alas, my brother!' or 'Alas, my sister!' They will not mourn for Him, saying, 'Alas, my master! Alas, His splendor!'</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jehoiakim** (jih-HOY-uh-kim) — "the LORD raises up" — king of Judah 609–598 BC, son of Josiah. He burned Jeremiah's scroll and was condemned by the prophet.

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| <p>19 <i>He shall be buried with the burial of an ass, drawn and cast forth beyond the gates of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Go up to Lebanon, and cry; and lift up thy voice in Bashan, and cry from the passages: for all thy lovers are destroyed.</i></p> | <p>He will have the burial of a donkey — dragged away and thrown outside the gates of Jerusalem.</p> <p>"Go up to Lebanon and cry out. Raise Your voice in Bashan. Cry out from Abarim, for all Your allies are crushed.</p> |
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- 21 *I spake unto thee in thy prosperity; but thou saidst, I will not hear. This hath been thy manner from thy youth, that thou obeyedst not my voice.* I warned You when You felt secure, but You said, 'I will not listen!' This has been Your pattern since Your youth — you have not obeyed Me.
- 22 *The wind shall eat up all thy pastors, and thy lovers shall go into captivity: surely then shalt thou be ashamed and confounded for all thy wickedness.* The wind will drive away all Your shepherds, and Your allies will go into exile. Then You will be ashamed and disgraced because of all Your wickedness.
- 23 *O inhabitant of Lebanon, that makest thy nest in the cedars, how gracious shalt thou be when pangs come upon thee, the pain as of a woman in travail!* You who live in Lebanon, who are nestled in cedar buildings, how You will groan when pain comes upon You — pain like that of a woman in labor!
- 24 *As I live, saith the LORD, though Coniah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah were the signet upon my right hand, yet would I pluck thee thence;* "As surely as I live," says the LORD, "even if You, Coniah son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, were a signet ring on My right hand, I would still pull You off.
- 25 *And I will give thee into the hand of them that seek thy life, and into the hand of them whose face thou fearest, even into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of the Chaldeans.* I will hand you over to those who seek your life, those you fear — Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and the Babylonians.
- 26 *And I will cast thee out, and thy mother that bare thee, into another country, where ye were not born; and there shall ye die.* I will hurl you and the mother who gave you birth into another country, where neither of you was born. There you will die.
- 27 *But to the land whereunto they desire to return, thither shall they not return.* You will never come back to the land you long to return to."

28	<i>Is this man Coniah a despised broken idol? is he a vessel wherein is no pleasure? wherefore are they cast out, he and his seed, and are cast into a land which they know not?</i>	Is this man Coniah a despised, broken pot — an object no one wants? Why will he and his children be hurled out and thrown into a land they do not know?
29	<i>O earth, earth, earth, hear the word of the LORD.</i>	Land! Land! Land! Hear the word of the LORD!
30	<i>Thus saith the LORD, Write ye this man childless, a man that shall not prosper in his days: for no man of his seed shall prosper, sitting upon the throne of David, and ruling any more in Judah.</i>	This is what the LORD says: "Record this man as childless — a man who will not prosper in his lifetime. None of His offspring will succeed in sitting on the throne of David or ruling in Judah."

Words in this chapter:

Bashan (BAY-shan) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 21:12; Mic 6:8; Jer 22:17; Jas 1:27; Ezek 22:7
- v5 — Amos 6:8; Heb 6:13; Gen 22:16; Jer 17:27
- v6 — Ps 107:34; Isa 6:11
- v8 — 1 Kgs 9:8-9; 2 Chr 7:20-22
- v10 — Eccl 4:2; Jer 22:11; Isa 57:1; Lam 4:9
- v13 — Lev 19:13; Mic 3:10; Jas 5:4; Mal 3:5; Deut 24:14-15
- v15 — 2 Kgs 23:25; Isa 3:10; Prov 25:5; Eccl 10:17; Prov 29:4
- v16 — Jer 9:24; Isa 1:17; 1 John 2:3-4; Titus 1:16; Ps 72:12-13
- v21 — Jer 32:30; Jer 7:22-28; Jer 3:25
- v25 — Jer 34:20-21; Jer 21:7
- v28 — Hos 8:8; Ps 31:12; Jer 48:38
- v29 — Deut 32:1; Mic 1:2; Jer 6:19; Mic 6:1-2; Isa 1:1-2

Chapter 23

The LORD pronounced woe on the shepherds who scattered His flock, and promised to raise up a righteous Branch from David who would reign as king and execute judgment and justice -- whose name would be called THE LORD OUR RIGHTEOUSNESS. He rebuked the prophets of Jerusalem who prophesied lies in His name, committed adultery, and strengthened the hands of evildoers.

- 1 *Woe be unto the pastors that destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture! saith the LORD.* "Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of My pasture!" says the LORD.
- 2 *Therefore thus saith the LORD God of Israel against the pastors that feed my people; Ye have scattered my flock, and driven them away, and have not visited them: behold, I will visit upon you the evil of your doings, saith the LORD.* Therefore this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says to the shepherds who tend My people: "Because You have scattered My flock and driven them away, and have not taken care of them, I will punish You for the evil You have done," says the LORD.
- 3 *And I myself will gather the remnant of my flock out of all countries whither I have driven them, and will bring them again to their folds; and they shall be fruitful and increase.* "I Myself will gather the remnant of My flock from all the countries where I have driven them. I will bring them back to their pasture, where they will be fruitful and multiply.
- 4 *And I will set up shepherds over them which shall feed them: and they shall fear no more, nor be dismayed, neither shall they be lacking, saith the LORD.* I will place shepherds over them who will tend them, and they will no longer be afraid or terrified. Not one of them will be missing," says the LORD.
- 5 *Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will raise unto David a righteous Branch, and a King shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth.* "The days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will raise up for David a righteous Branch — a King who will reign wisely and do what is just and right in the land.
- 6 *In his days Judah shall be saved, and Israel shall dwell safely: and this is his name whereby he shall be called, THE LORD OUR RIGHTEOUSNESS.* In His days Judah will be saved and Israel will live in safety. This is the name by which He will be called: THE LORD OUR RIGHTEOUSNESS.
- 7 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that they shall no more say, The LORD liveth, which brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;* "So the days are coming," says the LORD, "when people will no longer say, 'As the LORD lives, who brought the Israelites up out of Egypt,'

- 8 *But, The LORD liveth, which brought up and which led the seed of the house of Israel out of the north country, and from all countries whither I had driven them; and they shall dwell in their own land.* but they will say, 'As the LORD lives, who brought the descendants of Israel up out of the land of the north and out of all the countries where He had driven them.' Then they will live in their own land."
- 9 *Mine heart within me is broken because of the prophets; all my bones shake; I am like a drunken man, and like a man whom wine hath overcome, because of the LORD, and because of the words of his holiness.* My heart is broken within me because of the prophets. All my bones tremble. I am like a drunken man, like someone overcome by wine, because of the LORD and because of His holy words.
- 10 *For the land is full of adulterers; for because of swearing the land mourneth; the pleasant places of the wilderness are dried up, and their course is evil, and their force is not right.* The land is full of adulterers. Because of them the land mourns. The pleasant pastures in the desert are dried up. The prophets run in an evil course and use their power unjustly.
- 11 *For both prophet and priest are profane; yea, in my house have I found their wickedness, saith the LORD.* "Both prophet and priest are godless. Even in My temple I find their wickedness," says the LORD.
- 12 *Wherefore their way shall be unto them as slippery ways in the darkness: they shall be driven on, and fall therein: for I will bring evil upon them, even the year of their visitation, saith the LORD.* "Therefore their path will become slippery. They will be banished to darkness and there they will fall. I will bring disaster on them in the year I punish them," says the LORD.
- 13 *And I have seen folly in the prophets of Samaria; they prophesied in Baal, and caused my people Israel to err.* "Among the prophets of Samaria I saw something repulsive: They prophesied by Baal and led My people Israel astray.

- 14 *I have seen also in the prophets of Jerusalem an horrible thing: they commit adultery, and walk in lies: they strengthen also the hands of evildoers, that none doth return from his wickedness: they are all of them unto me as Sodom, and the inhabitants thereof as Gomorrah.* And among the prophets of Jerusalem I have seen something horrible: They commit adultery and live a lie. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that not one of them turns from their wickedness. They are all like Sodom to Me. The people of Jerusalem are like Gomorrah."
- 15 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts concerning the prophets; Behold, I will feed them with wormwood, and make them drink the water of gall: for from the prophets of Jerusalem is profaneness gone forth into all the land.* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts says concerning the prophets: "I will make them eat bitter food and drink poisoned water, because from the prophets of Jerusalem ungodliness has spread throughout the land."
- 16 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Harken not unto the words of the prophets that prophesy unto you: they make you vain: they speak a vision of their own heart, and not out of the mouth of the LORD.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Do not listen to what the prophets are prophesying to You. They fill You with false hopes. They speak visions from their own minds, not from the mouth of the LORD.
- 17 *They say still unto them that despise me, The LORD hath said, Ye shall have peace; and they say unto every one that walketh after the imagination of his own heart, No evil shall come upon you.* They keep saying to those who despise Me, 'The LORD says: You will have peace.' And to all who follow the stubbornness of their hearts they say, 'No harm will come to You.'
- 18 *For who hath stood in the counsel of the LORD, and hath perceived and heard his word? who hath marked his word, and heard it?* But which of them has stood in the council of the LORD to see or to hear His word? Who has listened and heard His word?
- 19 *Behold, a whirlwind of the LORD is gone forth in fury, even a grievous whirlwind: it shall fall grievously upon the head of the wicked.* A storm of the LORD has gone out in fury — a driving whirlwind. It will swirl down on the heads of the wicked.

- 20 *The anger of the LORD shall not return, until he have executed, and till he have performed the thoughts of his heart: in the latter days ye shall consider it perfectly.* The anger of the LORD will not turn back until He fully accomplishes the purposes of His heart. In days to come You will understand it clearly.
- 21 *I have not sent these prophets, yet they ran: I have not spoken to them, yet they prophesied.* I did not send these prophets, yet they ran with their message. I did not speak to them, yet they prophesied.
- 22 *But if they had stood in my counsel, and had caused my people to hear my words, then they should have turned them from their evil way, and from the evil of their doings.* But if they had stood in My council, they would have proclaimed My words to My people and would have turned them from their evil ways and from their evil deeds.
- 23 *Am I a God at hand, saith the LORD, and not a God afar off?* "Am I only a God nearby," says the LORD, "and not a God far away?"
- 24 *Can any hide himself in secret places that I shall not see him? saith the LORD. Do not I fill heaven and earth? saith the LORD.* Can anyone hide in secret places so that I cannot see them?" says the LORD. "Do I not fill heaven and earth?" says the LORD.
- 25 *I have heard what the prophets said, that prophesy lies in my name, saying, I have dreamed, I have dreamed.* "I have heard what the prophets say who prophesy lies in My name. They say, 'I had a dream! I had a dream!'
- 26 *How long shall this be in the heart of the prophets that prophesy lies? yea, they are prophets of the deceit of their own heart;* How long will this continue in the hearts of these lying prophets, who prophesy the delusions of their own minds?
- 27 *Which think to cause my people to forget my name by their dreams which they tell every man to his neighbour, as their fathers have forgotten my name for Baal.* They think the dreams they tell one another will make My people forget My name, just as their ancestors forgot My name through Baal worship.

- 28 *The prophet that hath a dream, let him tell a dream; and he that hath my word, let him speak my word faithfully: what is the chaff to the wheat? saith the LORD.* Let the prophet who has a dream recount the dream, but let the one who has My word speak it faithfully. For what has straw to do with grain?" says the LORD.
- 29 *Is not my word like as a fire? saith the LORD; and like a hammer that breaketh the rock in pieces?* "Is not My word like fire," says the LORD, "and like a hammer that breaks a rock in pieces?"
- 30 *Therefore, behold, I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that steal my words every one from his neighbour.* Therefore I am against the prophets," says the LORD, "who steal from one another words supposedly from Me.
- 31 *Behold, I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that use their tongues, and say, He saith.* I am against the prophets," says the LORD, "who wag their own tongues and yet declare, 'The LORD declares.'
- 32 *Behold, I am against them that prophesy false dreams, saith the LORD, and do tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies, and by their lightness; yet I sent them not, nor commanded them: therefore they shall not profit this people at all, saith the LORD.* I am against those who prophesy false dreams," says the LORD. "They tell them and lead My people astray with their reckless lies, yet I did not send or appoint them. They do not benefit these people in the least," says the LORD.
- 33 *And when this people, or the prophet, or a priest, shall ask thee, saying, What is the burden of the LORD? thou shalt then say unto them, What burden? I will even forsake you, saith the LORD.* "When these people, or a prophet or a priest, ask You, 'What is the burden of the LORD?' say to them, 'What burden? I will forsake You,' says the LORD.
- 34 *And as for the prophet, and the priest, and the people, that shall say, The burden of the LORD, I will even punish that man and his house.* But if a prophet or priest or anyone else claims, 'This is a burden from the LORD,' I will punish that person and their household.

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| <p>35 <i>Thus shall ye say every one to his neighbour, and every one to his brother, What hath the LORD answered? and, What hath the LORD spoken?</i></p> <p>36 <i>And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.</i></p> <p>37 <i>Thus shalt thou say to the prophet, What hath the LORD answered thee? and, What hath the LORD spoken?</i></p> <p>38 <i>But since ye say, The burden of the LORD; therefore thus saith the LORD; Because ye say this word, The burden of the LORD, and I have sent unto you, saying, Ye shall not say, The burden of the LORD;</i></p> <p>39 <i>Therefore, behold, I, even I, will utterly forget you, and I will forsake you, and the city that I gave you and your fathers, and cast you out of my presence:</i></p> <p>40 <i>And I will bring an everlasting reproach upon you, and a perpetual shame, which shall not be forgotten.</i></p> | <p>This is what each of You keeps saying to Your friends and fellow Israelites: 'What is the LORD's answer?' or 'What has the LORD spoken?'</p> <p>But You must no longer mention 'a burden from the LORD,' because every person's own word becomes their burden, and so You distort the words of the living God — the LORD of hosts, our God.</p> <p>This is what You keep saying to a prophet: 'What is the LORD's answer to You?' or 'What has the LORD spoken?'</p> <p>Although You claim, 'This is a burden from the LORD,' this is what the LORD says: You used the words 'a burden from the LORD,' even though I told You that You must not claim this.</p> <p>Therefore I will surely forget You and cast You out of My presence along with the city I gave to You and Your ancestors.</p> <p>I will bring everlasting disgrace on You and everlasting shame that will not be forgotten."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gomorraah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 10:21; Zech 11:15-17; Ezek 34:2-10; Ezek 13:3; Matt 9:36
- v3 — Amos 9:14-15; Jer 32:37; Isa 43:5-6; Jer 29:14; Jer 30:3
- v5 — Isa 4:2; Luke 1:32-33; Isa 52:13; Isa 9:7; Zech 6:12-13
- v6 — 1 Cor 1:30; Phil 3:9; Jer 33:16; Matt 1:21-23; Isa 54:17
- v7 — Jer 16:14-15; Jer 23:3; Isa 43:18-19; Jer 31:31-34
- v10 — Hos 4:2-3; Ps 107:34; Jer 9:2; Jer 9:10; Jer 5:7-8
- v12 — Jer 13:16; Prov 4:19; Jer 11:23; Ps 35:6
- v16 — Jer 14:14; Ezek 13:6; Matt 7:15; Ezek 13:3; 2 Cor 11:13-15
- v24 — Prov 15:3; Ps 139:7; Ps 90:8; Isa 29:15; 1 Kgs 8:27
- v29 — Heb 4:12; Jer 5:14; Luke 24:32; Jer 20:9; 2 Cor 10:4-5
- v30 — Deut 18:20; Ezek 13:8; Jer 14:14-15
- v32 — Lam 2:14; Zeph 3:4; Ezek 13:7-18; Jer 29:31; Jer 7:8

Chapter 24

After Nebuchadnezzar carried Jeconiah and the craftsmen of Judah to Babylon, the LORD showed Jeremiah two baskets of figs set before the temple. The good figs represented the exiles in Babylon, whom the LORD would watch over and bring back. The bad figs represented Zedekiah and those who remained in Jerusalem, whom the LORD would give up to be a curse among all nations.

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| <p>1 <i>The LORD shewed me, and, behold, two baskets of figs were set before the temple of the LORD, after that Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon had carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, and the princes of Judah, with the carpenters and smiths, from Jerusalem, and had brought them to Babylon.</i></p> | <p>After Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried into exile from Jerusalem Jehoiachin son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, together with the officials of Judah and the craftsmen and artisans of Jerusalem, and had taken them to Babylon — the LORD showed me two baskets of figs placed in front of the temple of the LORD.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>One basket had very good figs, even like the figs that are first ripe: and the other basket had very naughty figs, which could not be eaten, they were so bad.</i></p> | <p>One basket had very good figs, like those that ripen first. The other basket had very bad figs, so bad they could not be eaten.</p> |

- 3 *Then said the LORD unto me, What seest thou, Jeremiah? And I said, Figs; the good figs, very good; and the evil, very evil, that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.* Then the LORD asked me, "What do You see, Jeremiah?" "Figs," I answered. "The good ones are very good, but the bad ones are so bad they cannot be eaten."
- 4 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 5 *Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Like these good figs, so will I acknowledge them that are carried away captive of Judah, whom I have sent out of this place into the land of the Chaldeans for their good.* "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Like these good figs, I regard as good the exiles from Judah whom I sent away from this place to the land of the Babylonians.'
- 6 *For I will set mine eyes upon them for good, and I will bring them again to this land: and I will build them, and not pull them down; and I will plant them, and not pluck them up.* My eyes will watch over them for their good, and I will bring them back to this land. I will build them up and not tear them down. I will plant them and not uproot them.
- 7 *And I will give them an heart to know me, that I am the LORD: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God: for they shall return unto me with their whole heart.* I will give them a heart to know Me, that I am the LORD. They will be My people and I will be their God, for they will return to Me with all their heart.
- 8 *And as the evil figs, which cannot be eaten, they are so evil; surely thus saith the LORD, So will I give Zedekiah the king of Judah, and his princes, and the residue of Jerusalem, that remain in this land, and them that dwell in the land of Egypt:* "'But like the bad figs, which are so bad they cannot be eaten,' says the LORD, 'so will I deal with Zedekiah king of Judah, his officials, and the survivors from Jerusalem, whether they remain in this land or live in Egypt.'
- 9 *And I will deliver them to be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth for their hurt, to be a reproach and a proverb, a taunt and a curse, in all places whither I shall drive them.* I will make them abhorrent and an offense to all the kingdoms of the earth — a disgrace and a byword, an object of ridicule and cursing, wherever I banish them.

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- And I will send the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, among them, till they be consumed from off the land that I gave unto them and to their fathers.*

I will send the sword, famine, and plague against them until they are destroyed from the land I gave to them and their ancestors."

Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 29:2
- v6 — Jer 42:10; Jer 29:10; Jer 33:7; Jer 32:41; Jer 12:15
- v7 — Heb 8:10; Jer 30:22; Ezek 37:23; Ezek 36:24-28; Zech 8:8
- v9 — Jer 29:18; Deut 28:37; 1 Kgs 9:7; Jer 15:4

Chapter 25

Jeremiah warned the people for twenty-three years, but they did not listen. The LORD declared that the whole land would be a desolation, and the nations would serve the king of Babylon seventy years. After seventy years the LORD would punish Babylon. Jeremiah took the cup of the wine of God's fury and made all the nations drink it, for the LORD was calling for a sword on all the inhabitants of the earth.

- 1

The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, that was the first year of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon;

The word came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, which was the first year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon.
- 2

The which Jeremiah the prophet spake unto all the people of Judah, and to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying,

Jeremiah the prophet said to all the people of Judah and all those living in Jerusalem:

- 3 *From the thirteenth year of Josiah the son of Amon king of Judah, even unto this day, that is the three and twentieth year, the word of the LORD hath come unto me, and I have spoken unto you, rising early and speaking; but ye have not hearkened.* "For twenty-three years — from the thirteenth year of Josiah son of Amon king of Judah until this very day — the word of the LORD has come to me and I have spoken to You again and again, but You have not listened.
- 4 *And the LORD hath sent unto you all his servants the prophets, rising early and sending them; but ye have not hearkened, nor inclined your ear to hear.* And though the LORD has sent all His servants the prophets to you again and again, you have not listened or paid any attention.
- 5 *They said, Turn ye again now every one from his evil way, and from the evil of your doings, and dwell in the land that the LORD hath given unto you and to your fathers for ever and ever:* They said, 'Turn now, each of You, from Your evil ways and Your evil practices, and You can stay in the land the LORD gave to You and Your ancestors for ever and ever.
- 6 *And go not after other gods to serve them, and to worship them, and provoke me not to anger with the works of your hands; and I will do you no hurt.* Do not follow other gods to serve and worship them. Do not arouse My anger with what Your hands have made. Then I will not harm You.'
- 7 *Yet ye have not hearkened unto me, saith the LORD; that ye might provoke me to anger with the works of your hands to your own hurt.* But You did not listen to Me," says the LORD, "and You have aroused My anger with what Your hands have made, bringing harm to yourselves.
- 8 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts; Because ye have not heard my words,* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts says: 'Because You have not listened to My words,

- 9 *Behold, I will send and take all the families of the north, saith the LORD, and Nebuchadrezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will bring them against this land, and against the inhabitants thereof, and against all these nations round about, and will utterly destroy them, and make them an astonishment, and an hissing, and perpetual desolations.* I will summon all the peoples of the north and My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon,' says the LORD, 'and I will bring them against this land and its inhabitants and against all the surrounding nations. I will completely destroy them and make them an object of horror and scorn — a ruin forever.
- 10 *Moreover I will take from them the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride, the sound of the millstones, and the light of the candle.* I will remove from them the sounds of joy and gladness, the voices of bride and groom, the sound of millstones, and the light of every lamp.
- 11 *And this whole land shall be a desolation, and an astonishment; and these nations shall serve the king of Babylon seventy years.* This whole land will become a ruin and a wasteland, and these nations will serve the king of Babylon seventy years.
- 12 *And it shall come to pass, when seventy years are accomplished, that I will punish the king of Babylon, and that nation, saith the LORD, for their iniquity, and the land of the Chaldeans, and will make it perpetual desolations.* But when the seventy years are fulfilled, I will punish the king of Babylon and his nation — the land of the Babylonians — for their iniquity,' says the LORD, 'and will make it desolate forever.
- 13 *And I will bring upon that land all my words which I have pronounced against it, even all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah hath prophesied against all the nations.* I will bring on that land all the words I have spoken against it — everything written in this book, which Jeremiah prophesied against all the nations.

- 14 *For many nations and great kings shall serve themselves of them also: and I will recompense them according to their deeds, and according to the works of their own hands.* They themselves will be enslaved by many nations and great kings. I will repay them according to their deeds and the work of their hands."
- 15 *For thus saith the LORD God of Israel unto me; Take the wine cup of this fury at my hand, and cause all the nations, to whom I send thee, to drink it.* This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, said to me: "Take from My hand this cup filled with the wine of My wrath and make all the nations to whom I send you drink it.
- 16 *And they shall drink, and be moved, and be mad, because of the sword that I will send among them.* When they drink it, they will stagger and go out of their minds because of the sword I will send among them."
- 17 *Then took I the cup at the LORD's hand, and made all the nations to drink, unto whom the LORD had sent me:* So I took the cup from the LORD's hand and made all the nations to whom he sent me drink it:
- 18 *To wit, Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah, and the kings thereof, and the princes thereof, to make them a desolation, an astonishment, an hissing, and a curse; as it is this day;* Jerusalem and the towns of Judah and its kings and officials, to make them a ruin and an object of horror and scorn and cursing — as they are today;
- 19 *Pharaoh king of Egypt, and his servants, and his princes, and all his people;* Pharaoh king of Egypt, his attendants, his officials and all his people,
- 20 *And all the mingled people, and all the kings of the land of Uz, and all the kings of the land of the Philistines, and Ashkelon, and Azzah, and Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod,* and all the foreign people there; all the kings of Uz; all the kings of the Philistines — those of Ashkelon, Gaza, Ekron, and the people left at Ashdod;
- 21 *Edom, and Moab, and the children of Ammon,* Edom, Moab, and Ammon;

- 22 *And all the kings of Tyrus, and all the kings of Zidon, and the kings of the isles which are beyond the sea,* all the kings of Tyre and Sidon; the kings of the coastlands across the sea;
- 23 *Dedan, and Tema, and Buz, and all that are in the utmost corners,* Dedan, Tema, Buz, and all who are in distant places;
- 24 *And all the kings of Arabia, and all the kings of the mingled people that dwell in the desert,* all the kings of Arabia and all the kings of the foreign people who live in the desert;
- 25 *And all the kings of Zimri, and all the kings of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes,* all the kings of Zimri, Elam, and Media;
- 26 *And all the kings of the north, far and near, one with another, and all the kingdoms of the world, which are upon the face of the earth: and the king of Sheshach shall drink after them.* and all the kings of the north, near and far, one after another — all the kingdoms on the face of the earth. And after all of them, the king of Babylon will drink it too.
- 27 *Therefore thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Drink ye, and be drunken, and spue, and fall, and rise no more, because of the sword which I will send among you.* "Then tell them, 'This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Drink, get drunk and vomit, and fall to rise no more, because of the sword I will send among You.'
- 28 *And it shall be, if they refuse to take the cup at thine hand to drink, then shalt thou say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Ye shall certainly drink.* But if they refuse to take the cup from Your hand and drink, tell them, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: You must drink it!
- 29 *For, lo, I begin to bring evil on the city which is called by my name, and should ye be altogether unpunished? Ye shall not be unpunished: for I will call for a sword upon all the inhabitants of the earth, saith the LORD of hosts.* See, I am beginning to bring disaster on the city that bears My name, and will You indeed go unpunished? You will not go unpunished, for I am calling down a sword on all who live on the earth,' says the LORD of hosts."

- 30 *Therefore prophesy thou against them all these words, and say unto them, The LORD shall roar from on high, and utter his voice from his holy habitation; he shall mightily roar upon his habitation; he shall give a shout, as they that tread the grapes, against all the inhabitants of the earth.* "Now prophesy all these words against them and say to them: 'The LORD will roar from on high. He will thunder from His holy dwelling and roar mightily against His land. He will shout like those who tread grapes — He will shout against all who live on the earth.
- 31 *A noise shall come even to the ends of the earth; for the LORD hath a controversy with the nations, he will plead with all flesh; he will give them that are wicked to the sword, saith the LORD.* The uproar will resound to the ends of the earth, for the LORD will bring charges against the nations. He will judge all humanity. The wicked he will give over to the sword,' says the LORD.
- 32 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, evil shall go forth from nation to nation, and a great whirlwind shall be raised up from the coasts of the earth.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: 'Look — disaster is spreading from nation to nation. A mighty storm is rising from the ends of the earth.'
- 33 *And the slain of the LORD shall be at that day from one end of the earth even unto the other end of the earth: they shall not be lamented, neither gathered, nor buried; they shall be dung upon the ground.* At that time those slain by the LORD will be everywhere — from one end of the earth to the other. They will not be mourned or gathered or buried. They will be like dung lying on the ground.
- 34 *Howl, ye shepherds, and cry; and wallow yourselves in the ashes, ye principal of the flock: for the days of your slaughter and of your dispersions are accomplished; and ye shall fall like a pleasant vessel.* Wail, You shepherds, and cry out! Roll in the dust, You leaders of the flock! For Your time to be slaughtered has come. You will fall and shatter like fine pottery.
- 35 *And the shepherds shall have no way to flee, nor the principal of the flock to escape.* The shepherds will find no place to flee. The leaders of the flock will not escape.

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| <p>36 <i>A voice of the cry of the shepherds, and an howling of the principal of the flock, shall be heard: for the LORD hath spoiled their pasture.</i></p> <p>37 <i>And the peaceable habitations are cut down because of the fierce anger of the LORD.</i></p> <p>38 <i>He hath forsaken his covert, as the lion: for their land is desolate because of the fierceness of the oppressor, and because of his fierce anger.</i></p> | <p>Hear the cry of the shepherds, the wailing of the leaders of the flock — for the LORD is destroying their pasture.</p> <p>The peaceful meadows will be laid waste because of the LORD's fierce anger.</p> <p>Like a lion He has left His den, for their land has become desolate because of the sword of the oppressor and because of the LORD's fierce anger.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 11:7; Jer 1:2; Jer 26:5; Jer 7:13; 2 Chr 34:8
- v7 — 2 Kgs 21:15
- v9 — Jer 18:16; Jer 1:15; Isa 13:3; Hab 1:6-10; Ezek 29:18-20
- v11 — Dan 9:2; Zech 1:12; Zech 7:5; 2 Chr 36:21-22; Jer 25:12
- v12 — Dan 9:2; Isa 13:19
- v14 — Jer 51:6; Jer 50:9; Jer 27:7; Jer 50:41
- v15 — Ps 75:8; Isa 51:17
- v27 — Hab 2:16; Jer 25:16
- v29 — Ezek 38:21; Prov 11:31; 1 Pet 4:17
- v31 — Hos 4:1; Joel 3:2; Mic 6:2; Isa 66:16
- v32 — Isa 34:2; Jer 23:19
- v33 — Isa 66:16; Jer 8:2

Chapter 26

The LORD sent Jeremiah to the temple court to speak all the words He commanded, withholding nothing. When the priests and prophets heard, they seized him and said he deserved to die. The princes and people defended Jeremiah, citing the precedent of Micah the prophet whom Hezekiah did not put to death, but Urijah the prophet was killed by King Jehoiakim.

- 1 *In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah came this word from the LORD, saying,* Early in the reign of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came from the LORD:
- 2 *Thus saith the LORD; Stand in the court of the LORD's house, and speak unto all the cities of Judah, which come to worship in the LORD's house, all the words that I command thee to speak unto them; diminish not a word:* "This is what the LORD says: Stand in the courtyard of the LORD's house and speak to all the people of the towns of Judah who come to worship in the house of the LORD. Tell them everything I command You. Do not omit a word.
- 3 *If so be they will hearken, and turn every man from his evil way, that I may repent me of the evil, which I purpose to do unto them because of the evil of their doings.* Perhaps they will listen and each will turn from their evil way. Then I will relent and not bring on them the disaster I was planning because of the evil they have done.
- 4 *And thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD; If ye will not hearken to me, to walk in my law, which I have set before you,* Say to them, "This is what the LORD says: If You do not listen to Me and follow My law, which I have set before You,
- 5 *To hearken to the words of my servants the prophets, whom I sent unto you, both rising up early, and sending them, but ye have not hearkened;* and if You do not listen to the words of My servants the prophets whom I have sent to You again and again — though You have not listened —
- 6 *Then will I make this house like Shiloh, and will make this city a curse to all the nations of the earth.* then I will make this house like Shiloh and this city a curse among all the nations of the earth."
- 7 *So the priests and the prophets and all the people heard Jeremiah speaking these words in the house of the LORD.* The priests, the prophets, and all the people heard Jeremiah speak these words in the house of the LORD.

- 8 *Now it came to pass, when Jeremiah had made an end of speaking all that the LORD had commanded him to speak unto all the people, that the priests and the prophets and all the people took him, saying, Thou shalt surely die.* But as soon as Jeremiah finished telling all the people everything the LORD had commanded Him to say, the priests and prophets and all the people seized him and said, "You must die!
- 9 *Why hast thou prophesied in the name of the LORD, saying, This house shall be like Shiloh, and this city shall be desolate without an inhabitant? And all the people were gathered against Jeremiah in the house of the LORD.* Why do You prophesy in the LORD's name that this house will be like Shiloh and this city will be desolate and deserted?" And all the people crowded around Jeremiah in the house of the LORD.
- 10 *When the princes of Judah heard these things, then they came up from the king's house unto the house of the LORD, and sat down in the entry of the new gate of the LORD's house.* When the officials of Judah heard these things, they came up from the royal palace to the house of the LORD and took their seats at the entrance of the New Gate of the LORD's house.
- 11 *Then spake the priests and the prophets unto the princes and to all the people, saying, This man is worthy to die; for he hath prophesied against this city, as ye have heard with your ears.* Then the priests and the prophets said to the officials and all the people, "This man should be sentenced to death! He has prophesied against this city. You have heard it with your own ears!"
- 12 *Then spake Jeremiah unto all the princes and to all the people, saying, The LORD sent me to prophesy against this house and against this city all the words that ye have heard.* Then Jeremiah said to all the officials and all the people: "The LORD sent me to prophesy against this house and this city all the words You have heard.
- 13 *Therefore now amend your ways and your doings, and obey the voice of the LORD your God; and the LORD will repent him of the evil that he hath pronounced against you.* Now reform Your ways and Your actions and obey the LORD Your God. Then the LORD will relent and not bring the disaster He has pronounced against You.

- 14 *As for me, behold, I am in your hand: do with me as seemeth good and meet unto you.* As for me, I am in Your hands. Do with me whatever You think is good and right.
- 15 *But know ye for certain, that if ye put me to death, ye shall surely bring innocent blood upon yourselves, and upon this city, and upon the inhabitants thereof: for of a truth the LORD hath sent me unto you to speak all these words in your ears.* But be assured of this: If You put me to death, You will bring the guilt of innocent blood on yourselves and on this city and on those who live in it. For in truth the LORD has sent me to You to speak all these words in Your hearing."
- 16 *Then said the princes and all the people unto the priests and to the prophets; This man is not worthy to die: for he hath spoken to us in the name of the LORD our God.* Then the officials and all the people said to the priests and the prophets, "This man should not be sentenced to death! He has spoken to us in the name of the LORD our God."
- 17 *Then rose up certain of the elders of the land, and spake to all the assembly of the people, saying,* Some of the elders of the land stepped forward and said to the entire assembly of people:
- 18 *Micah the Morasthite prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and spake to all the people of Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Zion shall be plowed like a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of a forest.* "Micah of Moresheth prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah. He told all the people of Judah, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: Zion will be plowed like a field, Jerusalem will become a heap of rubble, the temple hill a mound overgrown with thickets.'
- 19 *Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all Judah put him at all to death? did he not fear the LORD, and besought the LORD, and the LORD repented him of the evil which he had pronounced against them? Thus might we procure great evil against our souls.* Did Hezekiah king of Judah or anyone else in Judah put him to death? Did not Hezekiah fear the LORD and seek His favor? And did not the LORD relent, so that He did not bring on them the disaster He had pronounced? We are about to bring a terrible disaster on ourselves!"

- 20 *And there was also a man that prophesied in the name of the LORD, Urijah the son of Shemaiah of Kirjathjearim, who prophesied against this city and against this land according to all the words of Jeremiah:* Now Urijah son of Shemaiah from Kiriath Jearim was another man who prophesied in the name of the LORD. He prophesied the same things against this city and this land as Jeremiah did.
- 21 *And when Jehoiakim the king, with all his mighty men, and all the princes, heard his words, the king sought to put him to death: but when Urijah heard it, he was afraid, and fled, and went into Egypt;* When King Jehoiakim and all his officers and officials heard his words, the king sought to put him to death. But Urijah heard of it and was afraid. He fled to Egypt.
- 22 *And Jehoiakim the king sent men into Egypt, namely, Elnathan the son of Achbor, and certain men with him into Egypt.* King Jehoiakim, however, sent Elnathan son of Achbor to Egypt, along with some other men.
- 23 *And they fetched forth Urijah out of Egypt, and brought him unto Jehoiakim the king; who slew him with the sword, and cast his dead body into the graves of the common people.* They brought Urijah out of Egypt and took him to King Jehoiakim, who had him struck down with a sword and his body thrown into the burial ground of the common people.
- 24 *Nevertheless the hand of Ahikam the son of Shaphan was with Jeremiah, that they should not give him into the hand of the people to put him to death.* Furthermore, Ahikam son of Shaphan supported Jeremiah and kept him from being handed over to the people to be put to death.

Words in this chapter:

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Shiloh (*SHY-lo*) — The central sanctuary where the tabernacle rested for about 300 years after Joshua — where Hannah prayed for a son and where the young Samuel served Eli.

Cross-References:

v2 — Deut 4:2; Matt 28:20; Acts 20:27; Jer 19:14; Jer 1:17

v3 — Jer 36:3; Jer 18:7-10; Isa 1:16-19

v5 — Jer 11:7

v6 — 2 Kgs 22:19; Jer 24:9

v11 — Jer 38:4

v14 — Josh 9:25

v18 — Mic 1:1; Neh 4:2; Zech 8:3

v19 — 2 Sam 24:16; Ex 32:14

Chapter 27

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to make yokes and send them to the kings of Edom, Moab, Ammon, Tyre, and Sidon, declaring that He had given all these lands to Nebuchadnezzar. Any nation that refused to serve Babylon would be punished with sword, famine, and pestilence. The prophets who said the vessels of the LORD's house would soon return from Babylon were lying.

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| <p>1 <i>In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah came this word unto Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,</i></p> | <p>Early in the reign of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thus saith the LORD to me; Make thee bonds and yokes, and put them upon thy neck,</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD said to me: Make a yoke out of straps and crossbars and put it on Your neck.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And send them to the king of Edom, and to the king of Moab, and to the king of the Ammonites, and to the king of Tyrus, and to the king of Zidon, by the hand of the messengers which come to Jerusalem unto Zedekiah king of Judah;</i></p> | <p>Then send word to the kings of Edom, Moab, Ammon, Tyre, and Sidon through the envoys who have come to Jerusalem to Zedekiah king of Judah.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And command them to say unto their masters, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Thus shall ye say unto your masters;</i></p> | <p>Give them a message for their masters and say, 'This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Tell this to Your masters:</p> |

- 5 *I have made the earth, the man and the beast that are upon the ground, by my great power and by my outstretched arm, and have given it unto whom it seemed meet unto me.* With My great power and outstretched arm I made the earth and its people and animals, and I give it to anyone I please.
- 6 *And now have I given all these lands into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant; and the beasts of the field have I given him also to serve him.* Now I will give all your countries to My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. I will make even the wild animals subject to him.
- 7 *And all nations shall serve him, and his son, and his son's son, until the very time of his land come: and then many nations and great kings shall serve themselves of him.* All nations will serve him and his son and his grandson until the time for his land comes. Then many nations and great kings will subjugate him.
- 8 *And it shall come to pass, that the nation and kingdom which will not serve the same Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, and that will not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, that nation will I punish, saith the LORD, with the sword, and with the famine, and with the pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand.* If, however, any nation or kingdom will not serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon or bow its neck under His yoke, I will punish that nation with sword, famine, and plague,' says the LORD, 'until I destroy it by His hand.
- 9 *Therefore hearken not ye to your prophets, nor to your diviners, nor to your dreamers, nor to your enchanters, nor to your sorcerers, which speak unto you, saying, Ye shall not serve the king of Babylon:* So do not listen to your prophets, your diviners, your dreamers, your fortune-tellers, or your sorcerers who tell you, "You will not serve the king of Babylon."
- 10 *For they prophesy a lie unto you, to remove you far from your land; and that I should drive you out, and ye should perish.* They prophesy lies to you that will only serve to remove you far from your lands. I would banish you and you would perish.

- 11 *But the nations that bring their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him, those will I let remain still in their own land, saith the LORD; and they shall till it, and dwell therein.* But if any nation will bow its neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon and serve him, I will let that nation remain in its own land to cultivate it and to live there,' says the LORD."
- 12 *I spake also to Zedekiah king of Judah according to all these words, saying, Bring your necks under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him and his people, and live.* I gave the same message to Zedekiah king of Judah. I said, "Bow your neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon. Serve him and his people, and you will live.
- 13 *Why will ye die, thou and thy people, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, as the LORD hath spoken against the nation that will not serve the king of Babylon?* Why will You and Your people die by the sword, famine, and plague with which the LORD has threatened every nation that will not serve the king of Babylon?
- 14 *Therefore hearken not unto the words of the prophets that speak unto you, saying, Ye shall not serve the king of Babylon: for they prophesy a lie unto you.* Do not listen to the words of the prophets who say to you, 'You will not serve the king of Babylon,' for they are prophesying lies to you.
- 15 *For I have not sent them, saith the LORD, yet they prophesy a lie in my name; that I might drive you out, and that ye might perish, ye, and the prophets that prophesy unto you.* I have not sent them," says the LORD. "They are prophesying lies in My name. Therefore I will banish You and You will perish — both You and the prophets who prophesy to You."
- 16 *Also I spake to the priests and to all this people, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Hearken not to the words of your prophets that prophesy unto you, saying, Behold, the vessels of the LORD's house shall now shortly be brought again from Babylon: for they prophesy a lie unto you.* Then I said to the priests and all these people, "This is what the LORD says: Do not listen to the prophets who say, 'Very soon now the articles from the LORD's house will be brought back from Babylon.' They are prophesying lies to You.

- 17 *Hearken not unto them; serve the king of Babylon, and live: wherefore should this city be laid waste?* Do not listen to them. Serve the king of Babylon, and you will live. Why should this city become a ruin?
- 18 *But if they be prophets, and if the word of the LORD be with them, let them now make intercession to the LORD of hosts, that the vessels which are left in the house of the LORD, and in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem, go not to Babylon.* If they are prophets and have the word of the LORD, let them plead with the LORD of hosts that the articles remaining in the house of the LORD and in the palace of the king of Judah and in Jerusalem not be taken to Babylon.
- 19 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts concerning the pillars, and concerning the sea, and concerning the bases, and concerning the residue of the vessels that remain in this city,* For this is what the LORD of hosts says about the pillars, the bronze Sea, the movable stands, and the other articles that remain in this city,
- 20 *Which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took not, when he carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah from Jerusalem to Babylon, and all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem;* which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon did not take when he carried away Jehoiachin son of Jehoiakim king of Judah into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon, along with all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem —
- 21 *Yea, thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, concerning the vessels that remain in the house of the LORD, and in the house of the king of Judah and of Jerusalem;* yes, this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says about the things that are left in the house of the LORD and in the palace of the king of Judah and in Jerusalem:
- 22 *They shall be carried to Babylon, and there shall they be until the day that I visit them, saith the LORD; then will I bring them up, and restore them to this place.* "They will be taken to Babylon and there they will remain until the day I come for them," says the LORD. "Then I will bring them back and restore them to this place."

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Cross-References:

v5 — Jer 32:17; Jer 51:15; Ps 115:15-16; Ps 146:5-6; Dan 4:17

v6 — Jer 28:14; Jer 25:9; Dan 2:37-38

v13 — Ezek 18:31

v14 — Jer 14:14

v16 — Jer 28:3; 2 Kgs 24:13

v19 — 2 Kgs 25:13

v20 — Jer 24:1

v22 — Jer 29:10; Jer 32:5; Ezra 7:19

Chapter 28

Hananiah the prophet broke the yoke from Jeremiah's neck and prophesied that within two years the LORD would break the yoke of Babylon and bring back the vessels and the exiles. Jeremiah said amen, may the LORD do so, but the prophet who prophesies peace is only proven when his word comes to pass. The LORD sent Jeremiah back with yokes of iron and declared that Hananiah would die that year -- and he did.

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| <p>¹ <i>And it came to pass the same year, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the fourth year, and in the fifth month, that Hananiah the son of Azur the prophet, which was of Gibeon, spake unto me in the house of the LORD, in the presence of the priests and of all the people, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the fifth month of that same year, the fourth year, early in the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, the prophet Hananiah son of Azzur, who was from Gibeon, said to me in the house of the LORD in the presence of the priests and all the people:</p> |
| <p>² <i>Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying, I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>Within two full years will I bring again into this place all the vessels of the LORD's house, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took away from this place, and carried them to Babylon:</i></p> | <p>Within two years I will bring back to this place all the articles of the LORD's house that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon removed from here and took to Babylon.</p> |

- 4 *And I will bring again to this place Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, with all the captives of Judah, that went into Babylon, saith the LORD: for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.* I will also bring back to this place Jehoiachin son of Jehoiakim king of Judah and all the other exiles from Judah who went to Babylon,' says the LORD, 'for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.'"
- 5 *Then the prophet Jeremiah said unto the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests, and in the presence of all the people that stood in the house of the LORD,* Then the prophet Jeremiah replied to the prophet Hananiah before the priests and all the people who were standing in the house of the LORD.
- 6 *Even the prophet Jeremiah said, Amen: the LORD do so: the LORD perform thy words which thou hast prophesied, to bring again the vessels of the LORD's house, and all that is carried away captive, from Babylon into this place.* He said, "Amen! May the LORD do so! May the LORD fulfill the words You have prophesied by bringing the articles of the LORD's house and all the exiles back to this place from Babylon.
- 7 *Nevertheless hear thou now this word that I speak in thine ears, and in the ears of all the people;* Nevertheless, listen to what I have to say in Your hearing and in the hearing of all the people:
- 8 *The prophets that have been before me and before thee of old prophesied both against many countries, and against great kingdoms, of war, and of evil, and of pestilence.* From early times the prophets who came before You and me have prophesied war, disaster, and plague against many countries and great kingdoms.
- 9 *The prophet which prophesieth of peace, when the word of the prophet shall come to pass, then shall the prophet be known, that the LORD hath truly sent him.* But the prophet who prophesies peace will be recognized as one truly sent by the LORD only if His prediction comes true."
- 10 *Then Hananiah the prophet took the yoke from off the prophet Jeremiah's neck, and brake it.* Then the prophet Hananiah took the yoke off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah and broke it.

- 11 *And Hananiah spake in the presence of all the people, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Even so will I break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from the neck of all nations within the space of two full years. And the prophet Jeremiah went his way.* Hananiah said before all the people, "This is what the LORD says: 'In the same way I will break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon off the neck of all the nations within two years.'" At this, the prophet Jeremiah went on his way.
- 12 *Then the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah the prophet, after that Hananiah the prophet had broken the yoke from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying,* Shortly after the prophet Hananiah had broken the yoke off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 13 *Go and tell Hananiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Thou hast broken the yokes of wood; but thou shalt make for them yokes of iron.* "Go and tell Hananiah, 'This is what the LORD says: You have broken a wooden yoke, but in its place You will get a yoke of iron.'
- 14 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; I have put a yoke of iron upon the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and they shall serve him: and I have given him the beasts of the field also.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: I will put an iron yoke on the necks of all these nations to make them serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and they will serve Him. I will even give Him control over the wild animals."
- 15 *Then said the prophet Jeremiah unto Hananiah the prophet, Hear now, Hananiah; The LORD hath not sent thee; but thou makest this people to trust in a lie.* Then the prophet Jeremiah said to Hananiah the prophet, "Listen, Hananiah! The LORD has not sent You, yet You have persuaded this nation to trust in lies.
- 16 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will cast thee from off the face of the earth: this year thou shalt die, because thou hast taught rebellion against the LORD.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'I am about to remove You from the face of the earth. This very year You are going to die, because You have preached rebellion against the LORD.'
- 17 *So Hananiah the prophet died the same year in the seventh month.* In the seventh month of that same year, the prophet Hananiah died.

Words in this chapter:

Gibeon (*GIB-ee-on*) — A Hivite city that tricked Joshua into a peace treaty — its inhabitants became servants of Israel; Solomon offered sacrifices here where God appeared to him in a dream.

Cross-References:

v9 — Deut 18:22; Jer 6:14

v10 — Jer 27:2

v14 — Deut 28:48

v15 — Jer 14:14-15; Jer 27:15; Jer 23:21; Ezek 13:2-3; Ezek 22:28

v16 — Jer 29:32

Chapter 29

Jeremiah sent a letter to the exiles in Babylon, telling them to build houses, plant gardens, marry, and seek the peace of the city where the LORD had sent them. He promised that after seventy years the LORD would visit them and bring them back, declaring, 'I know the thoughts I think toward you, thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope.'

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| <p>1 <i>Now these are the words of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem unto the residue of the elders which were carried away captives, and to the priests, and to the prophets, and to all the people whom Nebuchadnezzar had carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon;</i></p> | <p>This is the text of the letter that the prophet Jeremiah sent from Jerusalem to the surviving elders among the exiles and to the priests, the prophets, and all the other people Nebuchadnezzar had carried into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>(After that Jeconiah the king, and the queen, and the eunuchs, the princes of Judah and Jerusalem, and the carpenters, and the smiths, were departed from Jerusalem;)</i></p> | <p>This was after King Jehoiachin and the queen mother, the court officials and the leaders of Judah and Jerusalem, and the craftsmen and artisans had left Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>By the hand of Elasah the son of Shaphan, and Gemariah the son of Hilkiyah, (whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent unto Babylon to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon) saying,</i></p> | <p>He sent the letter by Elasah son of Shaphan and Gemariah son of Hilkiyah, whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent to King Nebuchadnezzar in Babylon. It said:</p> |

- 4 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, unto all that are carried away captives, whom I have caused to be carried away from Jerusalem unto Babylon;* "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says to all those I carried into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon:
- 5 *Build ye houses, and dwell in them; and plant gardens, and eat the fruit of them;* 'Build houses and live in them. Plant gardens and eat what they produce.
- 6 *Take ye wives, and beget sons and daughters; and take wives for your sons, and give your daughters to husbands, that they may bear sons and daughters; that ye may be increased there, and not diminished.* Marry and have sons and daughters. Find wives for Your sons and give Your daughters in marriage, so that they too may have sons and daughters. Multiply there — do not decrease.
- 7 *And seek the peace of the city whither I have caused you to be carried away captives, and pray unto the LORD for it: for in the peace thereof shall ye have peace.* Also, seek the peace and prosperity of the city to which I have carried You into exile. Pray to the LORD for it, because if it prospers, You too will prosper.'
- 8 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Let not your prophets and your diviners, that be in the midst of you, deceive you, neither hearken to your dreams which ye cause to be dreamed.* Yes, this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Do not let the prophets and diviners among You deceive You. Do not listen to the dreams You encourage them to have.
- 9 *For they prophesy falsely unto you in my name: I have not sent them, saith the LORD.* They are prophesying lies to You in My name. I have not sent them,' says the LORD.
- 10 *For thus saith the LORD, That after seventy years be accomplished at Babylon I will visit you, and perform my good word toward you, in causing you to return to this place.* This is what the LORD says: 'When seventy years are completed for Babylon, I will come to You and fulfill My good promise to bring You back to this place.

- 11 *For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.* For I know the thoughts that I think toward You, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give You an expected end.
- 12 *Then shall ye call upon me, and ye shall go and pray unto me, and I will hearken unto you.* Then You will call on Me and come and pray to Me, and I will listen to You.
- 13 *And ye shall seek me, and find me, when ye shall search for me with all your heart.* You will seek Me and find Me when You seek Me with all Your heart.
- 14 *And I will be found of you, saith the LORD: and I will turn away your captivity, and I will gather you from all the nations, and from all the places whither I have driven you, saith the LORD; and I will bring you again into the place whence I caused you to be carried away captive.* I will be found by You,' says the LORD, 'and will bring You back from captivity. I will gather You from all the nations and places where I have banished you,' says the LORD, 'and will bring You back to the place from which I carried You into exile.'
- 15 *Because ye have said, The LORD hath raised us up prophets in Babylon;* You may say, "The LORD has raised up prophets for us in Babylon" —
- 16 *Know that thus saith the LORD of the king that sitteth upon the throne of David, and of all the people that dwelleth in this city, and of your brethren that are not gone forth with you into captivity;* but this is what the LORD says about the king who sits on David's throne and all the people who remain in this city, your fellow citizens who did not go into exile with You —
- 17 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will send upon them the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, and will make them like vile figs, that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.* yes, this is what the LORD of hosts says: "I will send sword, famine, and plague against them and I will make them like bad figs that are so rotten they cannot be eaten.

- 18 *And I will persecute them with the sword, with the famine, and with the pestilence, and will deliver them to be removed to all the kingdoms of the earth, to be a curse, and an astonishment, and an hissing, and a reproach, among all the nations whither I have driven them:* I will pursue them with sword, famine, and plague and will make them abhorrent to all the kingdoms of the earth — a curse and an object of horror, scorn, and reproach, among all the nations where I drive them.
- 19 *Because they have not hearkened to my words, saith the LORD, which I sent unto them by my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them; but ye would not hear, saith the LORD.* For they have not listened to My words," says the LORD, "words that I sent to them again and again through My servants the prophets. And You exiles have not listened either," says the LORD.
- 20 *Hear ye therefore the word of the LORD, all ye of the captivity, whom I have sent from Jerusalem to Babylon:* Therefore, all You exiles whom I sent away from Jerusalem to Babylon, hear the word of the LORD.
- 21 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, of Ahab the son of Kolaiah, and of Zedekiah the son of Maaseiah, which prophesy a lie unto you in my name; Behold, I will deliver them into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon; and he shall slay them before your eyes;* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says about Ahab son of Kolaiah and Zedekiah son of Maaseiah, who are prophesying lies to You in My name: "I will hand them over to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will put them to death before Your very eyes.
- 22 *And of them shall be taken up a curse by all the captivity of Judah which are in Babylon, saying, The LORD make thee like Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire;* Because of them, all the exiles from Judah who are in Babylon will use this curse: 'May the LORD treat You like Zedekiah and Ahab, whom the king of Babylon burned in the fire.'

- 23 *Because they have committed villany in Israel, and have committed adultery with their neighbours' wives, and have spoken lying words in my name, which I have not commanded them; even I know, and am a witness, saith the LORD.* For they have done outrageous things in Israel — they have committed adultery with their neighbors' wives and have spoken in My name words I did not command. I know it and I am a witness to it," says the LORD.
- 24 *Thus shalt thou also speak to Shemaiah the Nehelamite, saying,* Tell Shemaiah the Nehelamite:
- 25 *Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying, Because thou hast sent letters in thy name unto all the people that are at Jerusalem, and to Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest, and to all the priests, saying,* "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: You sent letters in Your own name to all the people in Jerusalem, to the priest Zephaniah son of Maaseiah, and to all the other priests. You told Zephaniah:
- 26 *The LORD hath made thee priest in the stead of Jehoiada the priest, that ye should be officers in the house of the LORD, for every man that is mad, and maketh himself a prophet, that thou shouldest put him in prison, and in the stocks.* "The LORD has appointed You priest in place of Jehoiada. You are to be in charge of the house of the LORD over every madman who acts like a prophet. You should put Him in the stocks and the iron collar.
- 27 *Now therefore why hast thou not reproved Jeremiah of Anathoth, which maketh himself a prophet to you?* So why have You not rebuked Jeremiah from Anathoth, who acts as your prophet?"
- 28 *For therefore he sent unto us in Babylon, saying, This captivity is long: build ye houses, and dwell in them; and plant gardens, and eat the fruit of them.* He has even sent this message to us in Babylon: It will be a long time. Therefore build houses and settle down. Plant gardens and eat what they produce."
- 29 *And Zephaniah the priest read this letter in the ears of Jeremiah the prophet.* Zephaniah the priest, however, read the letter to Jeremiah the prophet.
- 30 *Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:

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| <p>31 <i>Send to all them of the captivity, saying, Thus saith the LORD concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite; Because that Shemaiah hath prophesied unto you, and I sent him not, and he caused you to trust in a lie:</i></p> <p>32 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite, and his seed: he shall not have a man to dwell among this people; neither shall he behold the good that I will do for My people, saith the LORD; because he hath taught rebellion against the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"Send this message to all the exiles: 'This is what the LORD says about Shemaiah the Nehelamite: Because Shemaiah has prophesied to You, even though I did not send Him, and has persuaded You to trust in lies —</p> <p>therefore this is what the LORD says: I will surely punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite and His descendants. He will have no one left among this people, nor will he see the good things I will do for My people,' says the LORD, 'because He has preached rebellion against the LORD.'"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ahab (*AY-hab*) — The most wicked king of the northern kingdom of Israel — married the Phoenician princess Jezebel and promoted Baal worship; his name means 'father's brother.'

Cross-References:

v7 — 1 Tim 2:1-2; Ezra 6:10; Ezra 7:23; 1 Pet 2:13-17; Dan 4:27
v8 — Eph 5:6; 2 Thess 2:9-11; Jer 5:31
v10 — Dan 9:2; Jer 24:6-7; Zech 7:5; Jer 25:12; Jer 27:22
v11 — Isa 55:8-12; Ps 33:11; Mic 4:12; Ps 40:5; Job 23:13
v12 — Matt 7:7-8; Jer 33:3; Ps 50:15; Ps 145:19; Ps 10:17
v13 — Deut 4:29-31; Ps 119:2; Matt 7:7; Ps 119:10; Jer 24:7
v14 — Ezek 36:1-38; Jer 30:3; 1 Chr 28:9
v18 — Jer 42:18; 2 Chr 29:8; Jer 15:4; Jer 34:17; Jer 24:9
v19 — Jer 6:19; Jer 26:5
v22 — Isa 65:15; Dan 3:6; Dan 3:21; Gen 48:20
v23 — Mal 3:5; Jer 23:14; Heb 4:13
v26 — Jer 20:1-2; 2 Kgs 9:11

Chapter 30

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to write all His words in a book, for the days were coming when He would bring His people back from captivity. Though Jacob's trouble would be great, the LORD would save him out of it and break his yoke. The LORD would restore health to Zion and heal her wounds, and David's city would be rebuilt.

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| 1 <i>The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,</i> | This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD: |
| 2 <i>Thus speaketh the LORD God of Israel, saying, Write thee all the words that I have spoken unto thee in a book.</i> | "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Write in a book all the words I have spoken to You. |
| 3 <i>For, lo, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will bring again the captivity of my people Israel and Judah, saith the LORD: and I will cause them to return to the land that I gave to their fathers, and they shall possess it.</i> | The days are coming,' says the LORD, 'when I will restore the fortunes of My people Israel and Judah,' says the LORD. 'I will bring them back to the land I gave their ancestors, and they will take possession of it.'" |
| 4 <i>And these are the words that the LORD spake concerning Israel and concerning Judah.</i> | These are the words the LORD spoke concerning Israel and Judah: |
| 5 <i>For thus saith the LORD; We have heard a voice of trembling, of fear, and not of peace.</i> | "This is what the LORD says: 'I hear a cry of fear — there is terror, not peace. |
| 6 <i>Ask ye now, and see whether a man doth travail with child? wherefore do I see every man with his hands on his loins, as a woman in travail, and all faces are turned into paleness?</i> | Ask and see: Can a man bear children? Then why do I see every man with his hands on his stomach like a woman in labor, and every face turned deathly pale? |
| 7 <i>Alas! for that day is great, so that none is like it: it is even the time of Jacob's trouble; but he shall be saved out of it.</i> | How awful that day will be! No other will be like it. It will be a time of trouble for Jacob, but he will be saved out of it. |
| 8 <i>For it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD of hosts, that I will break his yoke from off thy neck, and will burst thy bonds, and strangers shall no more serve themselves of him:</i> | In that day,' says the LORD of hosts, 'I will break the yoke off their necks and tear off their bonds. Foreigners will no longer enslave them. |

- 9 *But they shall serve the LORD their God, and David their king, whom I will raise up unto them.* Instead, they will serve the LORD their God and David their king, whom I will raise up for them.
- 10 *Therefore fear thou not, O my servant Jacob, saith the LORD; neither be dismayed, O Israel: for, lo, I will save thee from afar, and thy seed from the land of their captivity; and Jacob shall return, and shall be in rest, and be quiet, and none shall make him afraid.* So do not be afraid, My servant Jacob,' says the LORD. 'Do not be dismayed, Israel. I will surely save You from a distant place — your descendants from the land of their exile. Jacob will again have peace and security, and no one will make them afraid.
- 11 *For I am with thee, saith the LORD, to save thee: though I make a full end of all nations whither I have scattered thee, yet will I not make a full end of thee: but I will correct thee in measure, and will not leave thee altogether unpunished.* I am with You and will save You,' says the LORD. 'Though I completely destroy all the nations among which I scatter you, I will not completely destroy You. I will discipline You but only with justice. I will not let You go entirely unpunished.'
- 12 *For thus saith the LORD, Thy bruise is incurable, and thy wound is grievous.* "This is what the LORD says: 'Your wound is incurable, Your injury beyond healing.
- 13 *There is none to plead thy cause, that thou mayest be bound up: thou hast no healing medicines.* There is no one to plead your cause — no remedy for your sore, no healing for You.
- 14 *All thy lovers have forgotten thee; they seek thee not; for I have wounded thee with the wound of an enemy, with the chastisement of a cruel one, for the multitude of thine iniquity; because thy sins were increased.* All Your allies have forgotten You. They care nothing for You. I have struck You as an enemy would — with the punishment of the cruel — because Your iniquity is so great and Your sins so many.
- 15 *Why criest thou for thine affliction? thy sorrow is incurable for the multitude of thine iniquity: because thy sins were increased, I have done these things unto thee.* Why do You cry out over Your wound? Your pain has no cure! Because of Your great iniquity and Your many sins I have done these things to You.

- 16 *Therefore all they that devour thee shall be devoured; and all thine adversaries, every one of them, shall go into captivity; and they that spoil thee shall be a spoil, and all that prey upon thee will I give for a prey.* But all who devour You will be devoured. All Your enemies will go into exile. Those who plunder You will be plundered. All who make spoil of You I will despoil.
- 17 *For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD; because they called thee an Outcast, saying, This is Zion, whom no man seeketh after.* But I will restore You to health and heal Your wounds,' says the LORD, 'because You are called an outcast, Zion for whom no one cares.'
- 18 *Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will bring again the captivity of Jacob's tents, and have mercy on his dwellingplaces; and the city shall be builded upon her own heap, and the palace shall remain after the manner thereof.* "This is what the LORD says: 'I will restore the fortunes of Jacob's tents and have compassion on his homes. The city will be rebuilt on her ruins, and the palace will stand in its proper place.
- 19 *And out of them shall proceed thanksgiving and the voice of them that make merry: and I will multiply them, and they shall not be few; I will also glorify them, and they shall not be small.* From them will come songs of thanksgiving and the sound of rejoicing. I will add to their numbers, and they will not be decreased. I will bring them honor, and they will not be looked down on.
- 20 *Their children also shall be as aforetime, and their congregation shall be established before me, and I will punish all that oppress them.* Their children will be as they were before, and their community will be established before Me. I will punish all who oppress them.
- 21 *And their nobles shall be of themselves, and their governor shall proceed from the midst of them; and I will cause him to draw near, and he shall approach unto me: for who is this that engaged his heart to approach unto me? saith the LORD.* Their leader will be one of their own. Their ruler will arise from among them. I will bring Him near and He will come close to Me, for who is He who will devote himself to be close to Me?' says the LORD.

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| 22 | <i>And ye shall be my people, and I will be your God.</i> | 'So You will be My people, and I will be Your God.' |
| 23 | <i>Behold, the whirlwind of the LORD goeth forth with fury, a continuing whirlwind: it shall fall with pain upon the head of the wicked.</i> | See, the storm of the LORD will burst out in wrath — a driving whirlwind. It will swirl down on the heads of the wicked. |
| 24 | <i>The fierce anger of the LORD shall not return, until he have done it, and until he have performed the intents of his heart: in the latter days ye shall consider it.</i> | The fierce anger of the LORD will not turn back until He fully accomplishes the purposes of His heart. In days to come You will understand this. |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 29:14; Jer 16:15; Jer 30:18; Ezek 20:42; Jer 23:7-8
- v6 — Jer 4:31; Joel 2:6; Nah 2:10; Isa 21:3; Jer 6:24
- v7 — Dan 12:1; Mal 4:1; Dan 9:12; Zech 14:1-2; Joel 2:11
- v9 — Hos 3:5; Isa 55:3-5; Luke 1:69; Acts 13:34; Ezek 37:23-25
- v10 — Jer 46:27-28; Jer 29:14; Isa 43:5; Isa 44:2
- v11 — Jer 10:24; Jer 1:19; Jer 1:8; Isa 8:10; Jer 4:27
- v16 — Jer 10:25; Isa 33:1; Zech 2:8; Ex 23:22; Rev 13:10
- v17 — Ps 107:20; Jer 33:6; 1 Pet 2:24; Ps 103:3; Ex 15:26
- v18 — Hag 2:7-9; Ps 102:13; Jer 30:3; Jer 33:7; Jer 49:39
- v19 — Jer 33:22; Isa 51:11; Isa 60:22; Ezek 36:37; Isa 35:10
- v21 — Num 16:5; Ezek 34:23-24; Ezek 37:24; Acts 5:31; Mark 11:9-10
- v22 — Jer 31:33; Rev 21:3; Jer 24:7; Ezek 36:28; Zech 13:9

Chapter 31

The LORD declared His everlasting love for Israel and promised to build her again. Rachel weeps for her children, but the LORD tells her to stop weeping, for they shall come back from the enemy's land. The LORD will make a new covenant with Israel -- not like the one He made when He brought them out of Egypt -- writing His law on their hearts, and all shall know Him from the least to the greatest.

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| 1 <i>At the same time, saith the LORD, will I be the God of all the families of Israel, and they shall be my people.</i> | "At that time," says the LORD, "I will be the God of all the families of Israel, and they will be My people." |
| 2 <i>Thus saith the LORD, The people which were left of the sword found grace in the wilderness; even Israel, when I went to cause him to rest.</i> | This is what the LORD says: "The people who survived the sword found grace in the desert. Israel is going to find rest." |
| 3 <i>The LORD hath appeared of old unto me, saying, Yea, I have loved thee with an everlasting love: therefore with lovingkindness have I drawn thee.</i> | The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: "I have loved You with an everlasting love. I have drawn You with loving-kindness." |
| 4 <i>Again I will build thee, and thou shalt be built, O virgin of Israel: thou shalt again be adorned with thy tabrets, and shalt go forth in the dances of them that make merry.</i> | I will build You up again, and You will be rebuilt, Virgin Israel. Again You will take up Your tambourines and go out to dance with the joyful. |
| 5 <i>Thou shalt yet plant vines upon the mountains of Samaria: the planters shall plant, and shall eat them as common things.</i> | Again You will plant vineyards on the hills of Samaria. The farmers will plant them and enjoy their fruit. |
| 6 <i>For there shall be a day, that the watchmen upon the mount Ephraim shall cry, Arise ye, and let us go up to Zion unto the LORD our God.</i> | There will be a day when watchmen cry out on the hills of Ephraim, 'Come, let us go up to Zion, to the LORD our God.'" |

- 7 *For thus saith the LORD; Sing with gladness for Jacob, and shout among the chief of the nations: publish ye, praise ye, and say, O LORD, save thy people, the remnant of Israel.* This is what the LORD says: "Sing with joy for Jacob. Shout for the greatest of the nations. Make your praises heard and say, 'LORD, save Your people, the remnant of Israel.'
- 8 *Behold, I will bring them from the north country, and gather them from the coasts of the earth, and with them the blind and the lame, the woman with child and her that travaileth with child together: a great company shall return thither.* See, I will bring them from the land of the north and gather them from the ends of the earth. Among them will be the blind and the lame, expectant mothers and women in labor — a great crowd will return.
- 9 *They shall come with weeping, and with supplications will I lead them: I will cause them to walk by the rivers of waters in a straight way, wherein they shall not stumble: for I am a father to Israel, and Ephraim is my firstborn.* They will come with weeping. I will lead them beside streams of water on a level path where they will not stumble, because I am Israel's father and Ephraim is My firstborn son.
- 10 *Hear the word of the LORD, O ye nations, and declare it in the isles afar off, and say, He that scattered Israel will gather him, and keep him, as a shepherd doth his flock.* Hear the word of the LORD, You nations. Proclaim it in distant coastlands: 'He who scattered Israel will gather them and will watch over his flock like a shepherd.'
- 11 *For the LORD hath redeemed Jacob, and ransomed him from the hand of him that was stronger than he.* For the LORD has redeemed Jacob and has rescued him from the hand of those stronger than He.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (rih-DEM-shun) — "to buy back, to set free by paying a price. When God redeems His people, He pays the cost to release them from slavery, sin, or captivity."

- 12 *Therefore they shall come and sing in the height of Zion, and shall flow together to the goodness of the LORD, for wheat, and for wine, and for oil, and for the young of the flock and of the herd: and their soul shall be as a watered garden; and they shall not sorrow any more at all.* They will come and shout for joy on the heights of Zion. They will rejoice in the goodness of the LORD — the grain, the new wine, the olive oil, the young of the flocks and herds. They will be like a well-watered garden and will sorrow no more.
- 13 *Then shall the virgin rejoice in the dance, both young men and old together: for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow.* Then young women will dance and be glad — young men and old as well. I will turn their mourning into gladness. I will give them comfort and joy instead of sorrow.
- 14 *And I will satiate the soul of the priests with fatness, and my people shall be satisfied with my goodness, saith the LORD.* I will satisfy the priests with abundance, and My people will be filled with My goodness," says the LORD.
- 15 *Thus saith the LORD; A voice was heard in Ramah, lamentation, and bitter weeping; Rahel weeping for her children refused to be comforted for her children, because they were not.* This is what the LORD says: "A voice is heard in Ramah — mourning and great weeping. Rachel is weeping for her children and refusing to be comforted, because they are no more."
- 16 *Thus saith the LORD; Refrain thy voice from weeping, and thine eyes from tears: for thy work shall be rewarded, saith the LORD; and they shall come again from the land of the enemy.* This is what the LORD says: "Restrain Your voice from weeping and Your eyes from tears, for Your work will be rewarded," says the LORD. "They will return from the land of the enemy.
- 17 *And there is hope in thine end, saith the LORD, that thy children shall come again to their own border.* So there is hope for Your descendants," says the LORD. "Your children will return to their own land.

- 18 *I have surely heard Ephraim bemoaning himself thus; Thou hast chastised me, and I was chastised, as a bullock unaccustomed to the yoke: turn thou me, and I shall be turned; for thou art the LORD my God.* "I have surely heard Ephraim's moaning: 'You disciplined me like an unruly calf, and I have been disciplined. Restore me and I will return, because You are the LORD my God.
- 19 *Surely after that I was turned, I repented; and after that I was instructed, I smote upon my thigh: I was ashamed, yea, even confounded, because I did bear the reproach of my youth.* After I strayed, I repented. After I came to understand, I beat my chest. I was ashamed and humiliated because I bore the disgrace of my youth.'
- 20 *Is Ephraim my dear son? is he a pleasant child? for since I spake against him, I do earnestly remember him still: therefore my bowels are troubled for him; I will surely have mercy upon him, saith the LORD.* Is not Ephraim My dear son, the child in whom I delight? Though I often speak against Him, I still remember Him. Therefore My heart yearns for Him. I will surely have mercy on Him," says the LORD.
- 21 *Set thee up waymarks, make thee high heaps: set thine heart toward the highway, even the way which thou wentest: turn again, O virgin of Israel, turn again to these thy cities.* "Set up road signs. Put up guideposts. Take note of the highway, the road that You take. Return, Virgin Israel. Return to Your towns.
- 22 *How long wilt thou go about, O thou backsliding daughter? for the LORD hath created a new thing in the earth, A woman shall compass a man.* How long will You wander, unfaithful daughter? The LORD will create a new thing on earth — a woman will surround a man."
- 23 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; As yet they shall use this speech in the land of Judah and in the cities thereof, when I shall bring again their captivity; The LORD bless thee, O habitation of justice, and mountain of holiness.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "When I bring them back from captivity, the people in the land of Judah and in its towns will once again use these words: 'The LORD bless You, You righteous dwelling, You sacred mountain.'

- 24 *And there shall dwell in Judah itself, and in all the cities thereof together, husbandmen, and they that go forth with flocks.* People will live together in Judah and all its towns — farmers and those who move about with their flocks.
- 25 *For I have satiated the weary soul, and I have replenished every sorrowful soul.* I will refresh the weary and satisfy the faint."
- 26 *Upon this I awaked, and beheld; and my sleep was sweet unto me.* At this I awoke and looked around. My sleep had been pleasant to me.
- 27 *Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will sow the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the seed of man, and with the seed of beast.* "The days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will plant the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the offspring of people and of animals.
- 28 *And it shall come to pass, that like as I have watched over them, to pluck up, and to break down, and to throw down, and to destroy, and to afflict; so will I watch over them, to build, and to plant, saith the LORD.* Just as I watched over them to uproot and tear down, to overthrow and destroy and bring disaster, so I will watch over them to build and to plant," says the LORD.
- 29 *In those days they shall say no more, The fathers have eaten a sour grape, and the children's teeth are set on edge.* "In those days people will no longer say, 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge.'
- 30 *But every one shall die for his own iniquity: every man that eateth the sour grape, his teeth shall be set on edge.* Instead, everyone will die for their own iniquity. Whoever eats sour grapes — their own teeth will be set on edge.
- 31 *Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah:* "The days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah.

- 32 *Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which my covenant they brake, although I was an husband unto them, saith the LORD:* It will not be like the covenant I made with their ancestors when I took them by the hand to lead them out of Egypt — a covenant they broke, though I was a husband to them," says the LORD.
- 33 *But this shall be the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel; After those days, saith the LORD, I will put my law in their inward parts, and write it in their hearts; and will be their God, and they shall be my people.* "This is the covenant I will make with the house of Israel after that time," says the LORD. "I will put My law in their inward parts, and write it in their hearts. I will be their God and they will be My people.
- 34 *And they shall teach no more every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying, Know the LORD: for they shall all know me, from the least of them unto the greatest of them, saith the LORD: for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.* No longer will they teach their neighbors, or say to one another, 'Know the LORD,' because they will all know Me, from the least of them to the greatest," says the LORD. "For I will forgive their iniquity and will remember their sin no more."
- 35 *Thus saith the LORD, which giveth the sun for a light by day, and the ordinances of the moon and of the stars for a light by night, which divideth the sea when the waves thereof roar; The LORD of hosts is his name:* This is what the LORD says, He who appoints the sun to shine by day, who decrees the moon and stars to shine by night, who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar — the LORD of hosts is His name:
- 36 *If those ordinances depart from before me, saith the LORD, then the seed of Israel also shall cease from being a nation before me for ever.* "Only if these decrees vanish from My sight," says the LORD, "will Israel ever cease being a nation before Me."

- 37 *Thus saith the LORD; If heaven above can be measured, and the foundations of the earth searched out beneath, I will also cast off all the seed of Israel for all that they have done, saith the LORD.* This is what the LORD says: "Only if the heavens above can be measured and the foundations of the earth below searched out will I reject all the descendants of Israel because of all they have done," says the LORD.
- 38 *Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that the city shall be built to the LORD from the tower of Hananeel unto the gate of the corner.* "The days are coming," says the LORD, "when this city will be rebuilt for Me from the Tower of Hananel to the Corner Gate.
- 39 *And the measuring line shall yet go forth over against it upon the hill Gareb, and shall compass about to Goath.* The measuring line will stretch from there straight to the hill of Gareb and then turn to Goah.
- 40 *And the whole valley of the dead bodies, and of the ashes, and all the fields unto the brook of Kidron, unto the corner of the horse gate toward the east, shall be holy unto the LORD; it shall not be plucked up, nor thrown down any more for ever.* The whole valley where dead bodies and ashes are thrown, and all the terraces out to the Kidron Valley on the east as far as the corner of the Horse Gate, will be holy to the LORD. The city will never again be uprooted or demolished."

Words in this chapter:

Rachel (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'

Cross-References:

- v3** — Ps 103:17; Isa 54:8-9; Hos 11:4; Eph 2:4-5; Deut 33:3
v4 — Jer 33:7; Jer 31:13; Amos 5:2; Jer 30:18-19; Acts 15:12
v8 — Ezek 34:16; Jer 23:8; Isa 42:16; Mic 4:6; Heb 12:12
v13 — Ps 30:11; Isa 61:3; Isa 51:11; Isa 51:3; Jer 31:4
v15 — Matt 2:16-18; Ps 77:2; Jer 40:1; Jer 10:20; Isa 22:4
v16 — Ruth 2:12; Jer 30:3; Heb 6:10; Mark 5:38-39; Jer 33:7
v17 — Lam 3:21; Hos 3:5; Lam 3:18; Hos 2:15; Lam 3:26
v20 — Isa 55:7; Mic 7:18-19; Isa 63:15; Judg 10:16; Ps 103:13
v25 — Matt 5:6; Matt 11:28; John 4:14; Ps 107:9; Jer 31:14
v31 — Heb 10:16-17; Jer 31:31-34; Ezek 37:26; Jer 32:40; 2 Cor 3:6
v33 — 2 Cor 3:3; Heb 10:16; Heb 8:10; Ezek 11:19-20; Jer 24:7

v34 — Isa 43:25; Heb 8:12; Jer 33:8; 1 John 2:27; Isa 54:13

Chapter 32

While Jerusalem was under siege, the LORD told Jeremiah to buy a field in Anathoth from his cousin Hanameel as a sign that houses and fields would be bought again in the land. Jeremiah obeyed and prayed, marveling at the LORD's power. The LORD confirmed that though He was giving the city to the Chaldeans because of Judah's sin, He would gather His people and make an everlasting covenant with them.

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| <p>1 <i>The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar.</i></p> | <p>This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For then the king of Babylon's army besieged Jerusalem: and Jeremiah the prophet was shut up in the court of the prison, which was in the king of Judah's house.</i></p> | <p>The army of the king of Babylon was then besieging Jerusalem, and Jeremiah the prophet was confined in the courtyard of the guard in the royal palace of Judah.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For Zedekiah king of Judah had shut him up, saying, Wherefore dost thou prophesy, and say, Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall take it;</i></p> | <p>Now Zedekiah king of Judah had imprisoned him there, saying, "Why do You prophesy as You do? You say, 'This is what the LORD says: I am about to give this city into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will capture it.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And Zedekiah king of Judah shall not escape out of the hand of the Chaldeans, but shall surely be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon, and shall speak with him mouth to mouth, and his eyes shall behold his eyes;</i></p> | <p>Zedekiah king of Judah will not escape the Babylonians but will certainly be given into the hands of the king of Babylon. He will speak with him face to face and see him with his own eyes.</p> |

- 5 *And he shall lead Zedekiah to Babylon, and there shall he be until I visit him, saith the LORD: though ye fight with the Chaldeans, ye shall not prosper.* He will take Zedekiah to Babylon, where he will remain until I deal with Him,' says the LORD. 'If You fight against the Babylonians, You will not succeed.'"
- 6 *And Jeremiah said, The word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* Jeremiah said, "The word of the LORD came to me:
- 7 *Behold, Hanameel the son of Shallum thine uncle shall come unto thee, saying, Buy thee my field that is in Anathoth: for the right of redemption is thine to buy it.* 'Hanameel son of Shallum your uncle is going to come to you and say, "Buy my field at Anathoth, because as next of kin it is Your right and duty to buy it.'""
- 8 *So Hanameel mine uncle's son came to me in the court of the prison according to the word of the LORD, and said unto me, Buy my field, I pray thee, that is in Anathoth, which is in the country of Benjamin: for the right of inheritance is thine, and the redemption is thine; buy it for thyself. Then I knew that this was the word of the LORD.* Then, just as the LORD had said, my cousin Hanameel came to me in the courtyard of the guard and said, "Buy my field at Anathoth in the territory of Benjamin. Since it is Your right to redeem it and possess it, buy it for Yourself." I knew that this was the word of the LORD.
- 9 *And I bought the field of Hanameel my uncle's son, that was in Anathoth, and weighed him the money, even seventeen shekels of silver.* So I bought the field at Anathoth from my cousin Hanameel and weighed out for Him seventeen shekels of silver.
- 10 *And I subscribed the evidence, and sealed it, and took witnesses, and weighed him the money in the balances.* I signed and sealed the deed, had it witnessed, and weighed out the silver on the scales.
- 11 *So I took the evidence of the purchase, both that which was sealed according to the law and custom, and that which was open:* I took both the sealed copy of the deed of purchase — the one containing the terms and conditions — and the unsealed copy.

- 12 *And I gave the evidence of the purchase unto Baruch the son of Neriah, the son of Maaseiah, in the sight of Hanameel mine uncle's son, and in the presence of the witnesses that subscribed the book of the purchase, before all the Jews that sat in the court of the prison.*
- I gave this deed to Baruch son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the presence of my cousin Hanameel and of the witnesses who had signed the deed and of all the Judeans sitting in the courtyard of the guard.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Baruch** (BAIR-uk) — "blessed" — Jeremiah's faithful secretary and companion, who recorded the prophet's words and preserved his scrolls. He appears prominently from chapter 32 onward.

- 13 *And I charged Baruch before them, saying,*
- In their presence I gave Baruch these instructions:
- 14 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Take these evidences, this evidence of the purchase, both which is sealed, and this evidence which is open; and put them in an earthen vessel, that they may continue many days.*
- "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Take both this sealed deed of purchase and this unsealed deed and put them in a clay jar so they will last a long time.
- 15 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Houses and fields and vineyards shall be possessed again in this land.*
- For this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Houses, fields, and vineyards will again be bought in this land."
- 16 *Now when I had delivered the evidence of the purchase unto Baruch the son of Neriah, I prayed unto the LORD, saying,*
- After I had given the deed of purchase to Baruch son of Neriah, I prayed to the LORD:
- 17 *Ah Lord GOD! behold, thou hast made the heaven and the earth by thy great power and stretched out arm, and there is nothing too hard for thee:*
- "Ah, Lord GOD! You have made the heavens and the earth by Your great power and outstretched arm. Nothing is too hard for You.

- 18 *Thou shewest lovingkindness unto thousands, and recompensest the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them: the Great, the Mighty God, the LORD of hosts, is his name,* You show mercy to thousands and bring the punishment of the fathers' sins into the laps of their children after them. You are the great and mighty God, whose name is the LORD of hosts.
- 19 *Great in counsel, and mighty in work: for thine eyes are open upon all the ways of the sons of men: to give every one according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings:* Your purposes are great and Your deeds are mighty. Your eyes are open to all the ways of all people. You reward everyone according to their conduct and as their deeds deserve.
- 20 *Which hast set signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, even unto this day, and in Israel, and among other men; and hast made thee a name, as at this day;* You performed signs and wonders in Egypt and have continued them to this day, in Israel and among all people, and have gained the renown that is still Yours.
- 21 *And hast brought forth thy people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs, and with wonders, and with a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with great terror;* You brought Your people Israel out of Egypt with signs and wonders, with a strong hand and an outstretched arm, and with great terror.
- 22 *And hast given them this land, which thou didst swear to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey;* You gave them this land You had sworn to give their ancestors, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 23 *And they came in, and possessed it; but they obeyed not thy voice, neither walked in thy law; they have done nothing of all that thou commandedst them to do: therefore thou hast caused all this evil to come upon them:* They came in and took possession of it, but they did not obey You or follow Your law. They did not do what You commanded them to do. So You brought all this disaster on them.

- 24 *Behold the mounts, they are come unto the city to take it; and the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans, that fight against it, because of the sword, and of the famine, and of the pestilence: and what thou hast spoken is come to pass; and, behold, thou seest it.* See how the siege ramps are built up to take the city. Because of sword, famine, and plague, the city will be given into the hands of the Babylonians who are attacking it. What You said has happened, as You now see.
- 25 *And thou hast said unto me, O Lord GOD, Buy thee the field for money, and take witnesses; for the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans.* And though the city will be given into the hands of the Babylonians, You have said to me, Lord GOD: 'Buy the field with silver and have the transaction witnessed.'"
- 26 *Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 27 *Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh: is there any thing too hard for me?* "I am the LORD, the God of all people. Is anything too hard for Me?
- 28 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the Chaldeans, and into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and he shall take it:* Therefore, this is what the LORD says: I am about to give this city into the hands of the Babylonians and to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, who will capture it.
- 29 *And the Chaldeans, that fight against this city, shall come and set fire on this city, and burn it with the houses, upon whose roofs they have offered incense unto Baal, and poured out drink offerings unto other gods, to provoke me to anger.* The Babylonians who are attacking this city will come in and set it on fire. They will burn it down — along with the houses where the people aroused My anger by burning incense on their rooftops to Baal and pouring out drink offerings to other gods.

- 30 *For the children of Israel and the children of Judah have only done evil before me from their youth: for the children of Israel have only provoked me to anger with the work of their hands, saith the LORD.* The people of Israel and Judah have done nothing but evil in My sight from their youth. The people of Israel have done nothing but arouse My anger with what their hands have made," says the LORD.
- 31 *For this city hath been to me as a provocation of mine anger and of my fury from the day that they built it even unto this day; that I should remove it from before my face,* From the day it was built until now, this city has aroused My anger and wrath, so that I must remove it from My sight.
- 32 *Because of all the evil of the children of Israel and of the children of Judah, which they have done to provoke me to anger, they, their kings, their princes, their priests, and their prophets, and the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.* The people of Israel and Judah have provoked Me by all the evil they and their kings, officials, priests, and prophets — the people of Judah and those living in Jerusalem — have done.
- 33 *And they have turned unto me the back, and not the face: though I taught them, rising up early and teaching them, yet they have not hearkened to receive instruction.* They turned their backs to Me and not their faces. Though I taught them again and again, they would not listen or respond to discipline.
- 34 *But they set their abominations in the house, which is called by my name, to defile it.* They set up their vile images in the house that bears My name and defiled it.
- 35 *And they built the high places of Baal, which are in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to cause their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire unto Molech; which I commanded them not, neither came it into my mind, that they should do this abomination, to cause Judah to sin.* They built high places for Baal in the Valley of Ben Hinnom to sacrifice their sons and daughters to Molech, though I never commanded — nor did it enter My mind — that they should do such a detestable thing to lead Judah into sin.

- 36 *And now therefore thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, concerning this city, whereof ye say, It shall be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence;* "You are saying about this city, 'By sword, famine, and plague it will be given into the hands of the king of Babylon.' But this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says:
- 37 *Behold, I will gather them out of all countries, whither I have driven them in mine anger, and in my fury, and in great wrath; and I will bring them again unto this place, and I will cause them to dwell safely:* I will surely gather them from all the lands where I banish them in My furious anger and great wrath. I will bring them back to this place and let them live in safety.
- 38 *And they shall be my people, and I will be their God:* They will be My people and I will be their God.
- 39 *And I will give them one heart, and one way, that they may fear me for ever, for the good of them, and of their children after them:* I will give them singleness of heart and action, so that they will always fear Me and that all will then go well for them and for their children after them.
- 40 *And I will make an everlasting covenant with them, that I will not turn away from them, to do them good; but I will put my fear in their hearts, that they shall not depart from me.* I will make an everlasting covenant with them: I will never stop doing good to them, and I will inspire them to fear Me, so that they will never turn away from Me.
- 41 *Yea, I will rejoice over them to do them good, and I will plant them in this land assuredly with my whole heart and with my whole soul.* I will rejoice in doing them good and will assuredly plant them in this land with all My heart and soul.
- 42 *For thus saith the LORD; Like as I have brought all this great evil upon this people, so will I bring upon them all the good that I have promised them.* This is what the LORD says: As I have brought all this great calamity on this people, so I will give them all the prosperity I have promised them.

- 43 *And fields shall be bought in this land, whereof ye say, It is desolate without man or beast; it is given into the hand of the Chaldeans.* Once more fields will be bought in this land about which You say, 'It is a desolate wasteland, without people or animals — it has been given into the hands of the Babylonians.'
- 44 *Men shall buy fields for money, and subscribe evidences, and seal them, and take witnesses in the land of Benjamin, and in the places about Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, and in the cities of the mountains, and in the cities of the valley, and in the cities of the south: for I will cause their captivity to return, saith the LORD.* Men shall buy fields for money and subscribe evidences, seal them, and take witnesses in the land of Benjamin, in the places about Jerusalem, in the cities of Judah, in the cities of the mountains, in the cities of the valley, and in the cities of the south. For I will cause their captivity to return," says the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 37:21; Neh 3:25
v3 — Jer 34:2-3; Jer 21:4-7
v17 — Luke 1:37; Jer 32:27; Gen 18:14; Job 42:2; Matt 19:26
v18 — Jer 10:16; Ex 34:7; Deut 5:9-10; Ex 20:5-6; Deut 7:9-10
v19 — Jer 17:10; Matt 16:27; Isa 28:29; Ps 62:12; Jer 16:17
v27 — Matt 19:26; Jer 32:17; Isa 64:8; Ps 65:2; John 17:2
v35 — Jer 7:31; 2 Chr 33:6; Lev 18:21; Jer 19:5-6; Lev 20:2-5
v37 — Jer 23:3; Jer 23:6; Ezek 34:12-14
v38 — Ezek 11:19-20; Jer 24:7; Ps 144:15; Ezek 37:27; Rev 21:7
v39 — Ezek 11:19-20; Acts 4:32; John 17:21; Ezek 37:25; Jer 32:40
v40 — Jer 31:31-33; Ezek 36:26; Jer 24:7; Heb 6:13-18; Jas 1:17
v41 — Jer 24:6; Zeph 3:17; Amos 9:15; Isa 62:5; Hos 2:19-20

Chapter 33

While Jeremiah was still imprisoned, the LORD told him to call and He would answer and show him great and mighty things. The LORD promised to heal Jerusalem, reveal abundance of peace and truth, and cause the Branch of Righteousness to spring forth from David. The covenant with David and with the Levitical priests would stand as firm as the LORD's covenant

with day and night.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah the second time, while he was yet shut up in the court of the prison, saying,</i> | While Jeremiah was still confined in the courtyard of the guard, the word of the LORD came to Him a second time: |
| 2 | <i>Thus saith the LORD the maker thereof, the LORD that formed it, to establish it; the LORD is his name;</i> | "This is what the LORD says, He who made the earth, the LORD Who formed it and established it — the LORD is His name: |
| 3 | <i>Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not.</i> | Call to Me and I will answer You and show You great and mighty things You do not know. |
| 4 | <i>For thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, concerning the houses of this city, and concerning the houses of the kings of Judah, which are thrown down by the mounts, and by the sword;</i> | For this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says about the houses in this city and the royal palaces of Judah that have been torn down to be used against the siege ramps and the sword — |
| 5 | <i>They come to fight with the Chaldeans, but it is to fill them with the dead bodies of men, whom I have slain in mine anger and in my fury, and for all whose wickedness I have hid my face from this city.</i> | the houses where people fought the Babylonians but were filled with the bodies of those I struck down in My anger and wrath, those whose wickedness made Me hide My face from this city: |
| 6 | <i>Behold, I will bring it health and cure, and I will cure them, and will reveal unto them the abundance of peace and truth.</i> | 'Nevertheless, I will bring health and healing to it. I will heal My people and will let them enjoy abundant peace and security. |
| 7 | <i>And I will cause the captivity of Judah and the captivity of Israel to return, and will build them, as at the first.</i> | I will restore the fortunes of Judah and Israel and will rebuild them as they were before. |

- 8 *And I will cleanse them from all their iniquity, whereby they have sinned against me; and I will pardon all their iniquities, whereby they have sinned, and whereby they have transgressed against me.* I will cleanse them from all the iniquity they have committed against Me, and I will forgive all their iniquities by which they sinned against Me and rebelled against Me.
- 9 *And it shall be to me a name of joy, a praise and an honour before all the nations of the earth, which shall hear all the good that I do unto them: and they shall fear and tremble for all the goodness and for all the prosperity that I procure unto it.* Then this city will bring Me renown, joy, praise, and honor before all nations on earth that hear of all the good things I do for it. They will be in awe and will tremble at the abundant prosperity and peace I provide for it.'
- 10 *Thus saith the LORD; Again there shall be heard in this place, which ye say shall be desolate without man and without beast, even in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, that are desolate, without man, and without inhabitant, and without beast,* "This is what the LORD says: 'You say about this place, "It is a desolate wasteland, without people or animals." Yet in the towns of Judah and the streets of Jerusalem that are deserted — inhabited by neither people nor animals — there will be heard once more
- 11 *The voice of joy, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride, the voice of them that shall say, Praise the LORD of hosts: for the LORD is good; for his mercy endureth for ever: and of them that shall bring the sacrifice of praise into the house of the LORD. For I will cause to return the captivity of the land, as at the first, saith the LORD.* the sounds of joy and gladness, the voices of bride and groom, and the voices of those who bring thank offerings to the house of the LORD, saying, "Give thanks to the LORD of hosts, for the LORD is good. His mercy endures forever." For I will restore the fortunes of the land as they were before,' says the LORD.

- 12 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Again in this place, which is desolate without man and without beast, and in all the cities thereof, shall be an habitation of shepherds causing their flocks to lie down.* "This is what the LORD of hosts says: 'In this place, desolate and without people or animals — in all its towns — there will again be pastures where shepherds rest their flocks.
- 13 *In the cities of the mountains, in the cities of the vale, and in the cities of the south, and in the land of Benjamin, and in the places about Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, shall the flocks pass again under the hands of him that telleth them, saith the LORD.* In the cities of the mountains, in the cities of the vale, and in the cities of the south, and in the land of Benjamin, and in the places about Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, shall the flocks pass again under the hands of Him that counts them,' says the LORD.
- 14 *Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will perform that good thing which I have promised unto the house of Israel and to the house of Judah.* "'The days are coming,' says the LORD, 'when I will fulfill the good promise I made to the people of Israel and Judah.
- 15 *In those days, and at that time, will I cause the Branch of righteousness to grow up unto David; and he shall execute judgment and righteousness in the land.* In those days and at that time I will make a righteous Branch sprout from David's line. He will do what is just and right in the land.
- 16 *In those days shall Judah be saved, and Jerusalem shall dwell safely: and this is the name wherewith she shall be called, The LORD our righteousness.* In those days Judah will be saved and Jerusalem will live in safety. This is the name by which it will be called: The LORD Our Righteousness.'
- 17 *For thus saith the LORD; David shall never want a man to sit upon the throne of the house of Israel;* For this is what the LORD says: 'David will never fail to have a man to sit on the throne of Israel,

- 18 *Neither shall the priests the Levites want a man before me to offer burnt offerings, and to kindle meat offerings, and to do sacrifice continually.* nor will the Levitical priests ever fail to have a man to stand before Me continually to offer burnt offerings, to burn grain offerings, and to present sacrifices."
- 19 *And the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah, saying,* The word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 20 *Thus saith the LORD; If ye can break my covenant of the day, and my covenant of the night, and that there should not be day and night in their season;* "This is what the LORD says: 'If You can break My covenant with the day and My covenant with the night, so that day and night no longer come at their appointed time,
- 21 *Then may also my covenant be broken with David my servant, that he should not have a son to reign upon his throne; and with the Levites the priests, my ministers.* then My covenant with David My servant — and My covenant with the Levites who are priests ministering before Me — can be broken and David will no longer have a descendant to reign on his throne.'
- 22 *As the host of heaven cannot be numbered, neither the sand of the sea measured: so will I multiply the seed of David my servant, and the Levites that minister unto me.* I will make the descendants of David My servant and the Levites who minister before Me as countless as the stars in the sky and as measureless as the sand on the seashore."
- 23 *Moreover the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, saying,* The word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 24 *Considerest thou not what this people have spoken, saying, The two families which the LORD hath chosen, he hath even cast them off? thus they have despised my people, that they should be no more a nation before them.* "Have You not noticed that these people are saying, 'The LORD has rejected the two kingdoms He chose'? So they despise My people and no longer regard them as a nation.
- 25 *Thus saith the LORD; If my covenant be not with day and night, and if I have not appointed the ordinances of heaven and earth;* This is what the LORD says: 'If I have not made My covenant with day and night and established the laws of heaven and earth,

- 26 *Then will I cast away the seed of Jacob, and David my servant, so that I will not take any of his seed to be rulers over the seed of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: for I will cause their captivity to return, and have mercy on them.* then I will reject the descendants of Jacob and David My servant and will not choose one of his sons to rule over the descendants of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. For I will restore their fortunes and have compassion on them."

Words in this chapter:

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 29:12; Isa 65:24; Eph 3:20; Isa 48:6; Ps 91:15
v6 — John 10:10; Isa 30:26; Titus 3:5-6; Ps 67:2; Isa 58:8
v7 — Isa 1:26; Amos 9:14-15; Jer 30:3; Jer 31:4; Jer 29:14
v8 — Zech 13:1; Mic 7:18-19; Ezek 36:25; Ps 51:2
v9 — Isa 60:5; Ps 126:2-3; Zeph 3:17-20
v11 — 1 Chr 16:34; Ps 106:1; Ps 107:1; Ps 107:22; Heb 13:15
v14 — Hag 2:6-9; Jer 23:5; 1 Chr 17:13-14; 2 Cor 1:20; Gen 49:10
v15 — Jer 23:5-6; Isa 4:2; Isa 11:1-5; Zech 3:8
v16 — Jer 23:6; 1 Cor 1:30; Isa 45:17; Phil 3:9; 2 Cor 5:21
v20 — Ps 89:37; Gen 8:22; Isa 54:9-10; Ps 104:19-23; Jer 31:35-37
v25 — Jer 31:35-36; Ps 74:16-17; Jer 33:20; Ps 104:19; Gen 8:22
v26 — Jer 31:37; Isa 14:1; Hos 2:23

Chapter 34

Jeremiah told Zedekiah that the LORD would give Jerusalem to the king of Babylon and Zedekiah would be captured, but he would die in peace. The princes and people made a covenant to free their Hebrew slaves, then took them back into bondage. The LORD declared that because they profaned His name, He would give them to their enemies.

- 1 *The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and all his army, and all the kingdoms of the earth of his dominion, and all the people, fought against Jerusalem, and against all the cities thereof, saying,* While Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and all his army and all the kingdoms and peoples in the empire He ruled were fighting against Jerusalem and all its surrounding towns, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD:

- 2 *Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Go and speak to Zedekiah king of Judah, and tell him, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall burn it with fire:* "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: Go to Zedekiah king of Judah and tell him, 'This is what the LORD says: I am about to give this city into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will burn it down.
- 3 *And thou shalt not escape out of his hand, but shalt surely be taken, and delivered into his hand; and thine eyes shall behold the eyes of the king of Babylon, and he shall speak with thee mouth to mouth, and thou shalt go to Babylon.* You will not escape from his grasp but will surely be captured and given into his hands. You will see the king of Babylon with your own eyes. He will speak with you face to face. And you will go to Babylon.
- 4 *Yet hear the word of the LORD, O Zedekiah king of Judah; Thus saith the LORD of thee, Thou shalt not die by the sword:* Yet hear the word of the LORD, Zedekiah king of Judah. This is what the LORD says concerning You: You will not die by the sword.
- 5 *But thou shalt die in peace: and with the burnings of thy fathers, the former kings which were before thee, so shall they burn odours for thee; and they will lament thee, saying, Ah lord! for I have pronounced the word, saith the LORD.* You will die peacefully. As people made a funeral fire in honor of Your fathers, the former kings who preceded You, so they will make a fire in Your honor and lament for You, saying, "Alas, master!" I Myself make this promise,' says the LORD."
- 6 *Then Jeremiah the prophet spake all these words unto Zedekiah king of Judah in Jerusalem,* Jeremiah the prophet told all this to Zedekiah king of Judah in Jerusalem
- 7 *When the king of Babylon's army fought against Jerusalem, and against all the cities of Judah that were left, against Lachish, and against Azekah: for these defenced cities remained of the cities of Judah.* while the army of the king of Babylon was fighting against Jerusalem and the other cities of Judah that were still holding out — Lachish and Azekah. These were the only fortified cities left in Judah.

- 8 *This is the word that came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, after that the king Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people which were at Jerusalem, to proclaim liberty unto them;* The word came to Jeremiah from the LORD after King Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people in Jerusalem to proclaim freedom for the slaves.
- 9 *That every man should let his manservant, and every man his maidservant, being an Hebrew or an Hebrewess, go free; that none should serve himself of them, to wit, of a Jew his brother.* Everyone was to free their Hebrew slaves, both male and female. No one was to hold a fellow Hebrew in bondage.
- 10 *Now when all the princes, and all the people, which had entered into the covenant, heard that every one should let his manservant, and every one his maidservant, go free, that none should serve themselves of them any more, then they obeyed, and let them go.* So all the officials and people who entered into this covenant agreed that they would free their male and female slaves and no longer hold them in bondage. They agreed, and set them free.
- 11 *But afterward they turned, and caused the servants and the handmaids, whom they had let go free, to return, and brought them into subjection for servants and for handmaids.* But afterward they changed their minds and took back the slaves they had freed and enslaved them again.
- 12 *Therefore the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 13 *Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; I made a covenant with your fathers in the day that I brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondmen, saying,* "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: I made a covenant with Your ancestors when I brought them out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery. I said:

- 14 *At the end of seven years let ye go every man his brother an Hebrew, which hath been sold unto thee; and when he hath served thee six years, thou shalt let him go free from thee: but your fathers hearkened not unto me, neither inclined their ear.* 'Every seventh year each of You must free any fellow Hebrew who has sold Himself to You. After He has served You six years, You must let Him go free.' But Your ancestors did not listen to Me or pay attention to Me.
- 15 *And ye were now turned, and had done right in my sight, in proclaiming liberty every man to his neighbour; and ye had made a covenant before me in the house which is called by my name:* Recently You repented and did what is right in My sight: each of You proclaimed freedom to Your neighbors. You even made a covenant before Me in the house that bears My name.
- 16 *But ye turned and polluted my name, and caused every man his servant, and every man his handmaid, whom he had set at liberty at their pleasure, to return, and brought them into subjection, to be unto you for servants and for handmaids.* But then You turned around and profaned My name. Each of You took back the male and female slaves You had set free. You forced them to become Your slaves again.
- 17 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; Ye have not hearkened unto me, in proclaiming liberty, every one to his brother, and every man to his neighbour: behold, I proclaim a liberty for you, saith the LORD, to the sword, to the pestilence, and to the famine; and I will make you to be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: You have not obeyed Me — you have not proclaimed freedom to Your own people. So I now proclaim 'freedom' for You," says the LORD — "freedom to fall by the sword, plague, and famine. I will make You abhorrent to all the kingdoms of the earth.
- 18 *And I will give the men that have transgressed my covenant, which have not performed the words of the covenant which they had made before me, when they cut the calf in twain, and passed between the parts thereof,* Those who have violated My covenant and have not fulfilled the terms of the covenant they made before Me, I will treat like the calf they cut in two and then walked between its pieces.

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| <p>19 <i>The princes of Judah, and the princes of Jerusalem, the eunuchs, and the priests, and all the people of the land, which passed between the parts of the calf;</i></p> <p>20 <i>I will even give them into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of them that seek their life: and their dead bodies shall be for meat unto the fowls of the heaven, and to the beasts of the earth.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Zedekiah king of Judah and his princes will I give into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of them that seek their life, and into the hand of the king of Babylon's army, which are gone up from you.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Behold, I will command, saith the LORD, and cause them to return to this city; and they shall fight against it, and take it, and burn it with fire: and I will make the cities of Judah a desolation without an inhabitant.</i></p> | <p>The leaders of Judah and Jerusalem, the court officials, the priests, and all the people of the land who walked between the pieces of the calf —</p> <p>I will give them into the hands of their enemies who want to kill them. Their bodies will be food for the birds of the air and the wild animals.</p> <p>I will give Zedekiah king of Judah and his officials into the hands of their enemies who want to kill them — to the army of the king of Babylon, which has withdrawn from you.</p> <p>I am going to give the order," says the LORD, "and I will bring them back to this city. They will fight against it, take it, and burn it down. And I will lay waste the towns of Judah so no one can live there."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Cross-References:

v2 — Jer 21:10
v3 — Jer 32:4; Jer 21:7
v5 — Jer 22:18; 2 Chr 16:14
v7 — Josh 10:3
v8 — Lev 25:10
v14 — Deut 15:12
v15 — Jer 34:8
v16 — Lev 19:12

- v17 — Matt 7:2
- v18 — Gen 15:10
- v20 — Jer 7:33; Jer 19:7; Jer 16:4
- v22 — Jer 9:11

Chapter 35

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to bring the Rechabites into the temple and offer them wine. They refused, saying their ancestor Jonadab had commanded them never to drink wine, build houses, or plant vineyards. The LORD held up the Rechabites as an example of obedience that shamed Judah, for Judah would not listen to the LORD though He spoke to them persistently.

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| 1 | <i>The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, saying,</i> | This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD during the reign of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah: |
| 2 | <i>Go unto the house of the Rechabites, and speak unto them, and bring them into the house of the LORD, into one of the chambers, and give them wine to drink.</i> | "Go to the community of the Rechabites and invite them to come to the house of the LORD into one of the side rooms. Then offer them wine." |
| 3 | <i>Then I took Jaazaniah the son of Jeremiah, the son of Habaziniyah, and his brethren, and all his sons, and the whole house of the Rechabites;</i> | So I went to get Jaazaniah son of Jeremiah, the son of Habazziniah, and his brothers and all His sons — the whole community of the Rechabites. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Rechabites** (REE-kuh-bites) — descendants of Jonadab (Jehonadab) son of Rechab, who commanded his descendants to live in tents, plant no vineyards, and drink no wine as a sign of separation from Canaanite culture. Their obedience to their ancestor becomes a rebuke to Judah's disobedience to God.

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| 4 | <i>And I brought them into the house of the LORD, into the chamber of the sons of Hanan, the son of Igdaliah, a man of God, which was by the chamber of the princes, which was above the chamber of Maaseiah the son of Shallum, the keeper of the door:</i> | I brought them into the house of the LORD, into the room of the sons of Hanan son of Igdaliah the man of God. This room was next to the room of the officials and directly above the room of Maaseiah son of Shallum the doorkeeper. |
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- 5 *And I set before the sons of the house of the Rechabites pots full of wine, and cups, and I said unto them, Drink ye wine.* Then I set bowls full of wine and some cups before the Rechabites and said, "Drink some wine."
- 6 *But they said, We will drink no wine: for Jonadab the son of Rechab our father commanded us, saying, Ye shall drink no wine, neither ye, nor your sons for ever:* But they replied, "We do not drink wine, because our ancestor Jonadab son of Rechab gave us this command: 'Neither You nor Your descendants must ever drink wine.
- 7 *Neither shall ye build house, nor sow seed, nor plant vineyard, nor have any: but all your days ye shall dwell in tents; that ye may live many days in the land where ye be strangers.* Also You must never build houses, sow seed, or plant vineyards. You must never have any of these things. Instead You must always live in tents. Then You will live a long time in the land where You are strangers.'
- 8 *Thus have we obeyed the voice of Jonadab the son of Rechab our father in all that he hath charged us, to drink no wine all our days, we, our wives, our sons, nor our daughters;* We have obeyed everything Jonadab son of Rechab our ancestor commanded us. Neither we nor our wives nor our sons nor our daughters have ever drunk wine
- 9 *Nor to build houses for us to dwell in: neither have we vineyard, nor field, nor seed:* or built houses or had vineyards, fields, or crops.
- 10 *But we have dwelt in tents, and have obeyed, and done according to all that Jonadab our father commanded us.* We have lived in tents and have fully obeyed everything our ancestor Jonadab commanded us.
- 11 *But it came to pass, when Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon came up into the land, that we said, Come, and let us go to Jerusalem for fear of the army of the Chaldeans, and for fear of the army of the Syrians: so we dwell at Jerusalem.* But when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon invaded this land, we said, 'Come, we must go to Jerusalem to escape the Babylonian and Aramean armies.' So we have been living in Jerusalem."
- 12 *Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:

- 13 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Go and tell the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, Will ye not receive instruction to hearken to my words? saith the LORD.*
- 14 *The words of Jonadab the son of Rechab, that he commanded his sons not to drink wine, are performed; for unto this day they drink none, but obey their father's commandment: notwithstanding I have spoken unto you, rising early and speaking; but ye hearkened not unto me.*
- 15 *I have sent also unto you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, Return ye now every man from his evil way, and amend your doings, and go not after other gods to serve them, and ye shall dwell in the land which I have given to you and to your fathers: but ye have not inclined your ear, nor hearkened unto me.*
- 16 *Because the sons of Jonadab the son of Rechab have performed the commandment of their father, which he commanded them; but this people hath not hearkened unto me:*
- "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Go and tell the people of Judah and those living in Jerusalem, 'Will You not learn a lesson and obey My words?' says the LORD.
- Jonadab son of Rechab ordered His descendants not to drink wine, and this command has been kept. To this day they do not drink wine, because they obey their ancestor's command. But I have spoken to You again and again, yet You have not obeyed Me.
- Again and again I sent all My servants the prophets to You. They said, "Each of You must turn from Your wicked ways and reform Your actions. Do not follow other gods to serve them. Then You will live in the land I have given to You and Your ancestors." But You have not paid attention or listened to Me.
- The descendants of Jonadab son of Rechab have carried out the command their ancestor gave them, but this people has not obeyed Me.'

- 17 *Therefore thus saith the LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring upon Judah and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem all the evil that I have pronounced against them: because I have spoken unto them, but they have not heard; and I have called unto them, but they have not answered.* Therefore this is what the LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Listen! I am going to bring on Judah and on everyone living in Jerusalem every disaster I pronounced against them. I spoke to them, but they did not listen. I called to them, but they did not answer.'
- 18 *And Jeremiah said unto the house of the Rechabites, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Because ye have obeyed the commandment of Jonadab your father, and kept all his precepts, and done according unto all that he hath commanded you:* Then Jeremiah said to the family of the Rechabites, "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'You have obeyed the command of Your ancestor Jonadab and have followed all His instructions and have done everything He ordered.'
- 19 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Jonadab the son of Rechab shall not want a man to stand before me for ever.* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Jonadab son of Rechab will never fail to have a descendant to serve Me.'"

Words in this chapter:

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 1 Chr 2:55

v4 — Deut 33:1

v13 — Jer 32:33

v14 — Jer 25:3-4; Jer 7:24-26; Jer 7:13; Prov 1:20-33; Jer 11:7

v15 — Jer 18:11; Ezek 18:30-32; Jer 25:5-6

v17 — Isa 66:4; Jer 7:13; Isa 65:12; Rom 10:21

v18 — Deut 5:16; Ex 20:12

v19 — Jer 15:19; Luke 21:36

Chapter 36

The LORD commanded Jeremiah to write all His words on a scroll. Baruch the scribe wrote at Jeremiah's dictation and read the scroll in the temple. King Jehoiakim had the scroll brought to him and cut it with a knife, piece by piece, and burned it in the fire. The LORD commanded Jeremiah to write another scroll, adding many similar words, and declared that Jehoiakim's dead body would be cast out.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, that this word came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Take thee a roll of a book, and write therein all the words that I have spoken unto thee against Israel, and against Judah, and against all the nations, from the day I spake unto thee, from the days of Josiah, even unto this day.</i></p> | <p>"Take a scroll and write on it all the words I have spoken to you concerning Israel, Judah, and all the other nations from the time I began speaking to you in the reign of Josiah until now.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>It may be that the house of Judah will hear all the evil that I purpose to do unto them; that they may return every man from his evil way; that I may forgive their iniquity and their sin.</i></p> | <p>Perhaps when the people of Judah hear about every disaster I plan to bring on them, they will each turn from their wicked ways. Then I will forgive their iniquity and their sin."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then Jeremiah called Baruch the son of Neriah: and Baruch wrote from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the LORD, which he had spoken unto him, upon a roll of a book.</i></p> | <p>So Jeremiah called Baruch son of Neriah, and while Jeremiah dictated all the words the LORD had spoken to Him, Baruch wrote them on the scroll.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And Jeremiah commanded Baruch, saying, I am shut up; I cannot go into the house of the LORD:</i></p> | <p>Then Jeremiah told Baruch, "I am restricted. I cannot go to the LORD's temple.</p> |

- 6 *Therefore go thou, and read in the roll, which thou hast written from my mouth, the words of the LORD in the ears of the people in the LORD's house upon the fasting day: and also thou shalt read them in the ears of all Judah that come out of their cities.* So You go to the house of the LORD on a day of fasting and read to the people from the scroll the words of the LORD that You wrote as I dictated. Read them to all the people of Judah who come in from their towns.
- 7 *It may be they will present their supplication before the LORD, and will return every one from his evil way: for great is the anger and the fury that the LORD hath pronounced against this people.* Perhaps they will bring their petition before the LORD and will each turn from their wicked ways, for the anger and wrath pronounced against this people by the LORD are great."
- 8 *And Baruch the son of Neriah did according to all that Jeremiah the prophet commanded him, reading in the book the words of the LORD in the LORD's house.* Baruch son of Neriah did everything Jeremiah the prophet told him to do. At the LORD's temple He read the words of the LORD from the scroll.
- 9 *And it came to pass in the fifth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, in the ninth month, that they proclaimed a fast before the LORD to all the people in Jerusalem, and to all the people that came from the cities of Judah unto Jerusalem.* In the ninth month of the fifth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, a time of fasting before the LORD was proclaimed for all the people in Jerusalem and those who had come from the towns of Judah.
- 10 *Then read Baruch in the book the words of Jeremiah in the house of the LORD, in the chamber of Gemariah the son of Shaphan the scribe, in the higher court, at the entry of the new gate of the LORD's house, in the ears of all the people.* From the room of Gemariah son of Shaphan the secretary, which was in the upper courtyard at the entrance of the New Gate of the temple, Baruch read to all the people at the temple the words of Jeremiah from the scroll.
- 11 *When Micaiah the son of Gemariah, the son of Shaphan, had heard out of the book all the words of the LORD,* When Micaiah son of Gemariah, the son of Shaphan, heard all the words of the LORD from the scroll,

- 12 *Then he went down into the king's house, into the scribe's chamber: and, lo, all the princes sat there, even Elishama the scribe, and Delaiah the son of Shemaiah, and Elnathan the son of Achbor, and Gemariah the son of Shaphan, and Zedekiah the son of Hananiah, and all the princes.* he went down to the secretary's room in the royal palace, where all the officials were sitting: Elishama the secretary, Delaiah son of Shemaiah, Elnathan son of Achbor, Gemariah son of Shaphan, Zedekiah son of Hananiah, and all the other officials.
- 13 *Then Michaiah declared unto them all the words that he had heard, when Baruch read the book in the ears of the people.* Micaiah told them everything He had heard Baruch read to the people from the scroll.
- 14 *Therefore all the princes sent Jehudi the son of Nethaniah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, unto Baruch, saying, Take in thine hand the roll wherein thou hast read in the ears of the people, and come. So Baruch the son of Neriah took the roll in his hand, and came unto them.* Then all the officials sent Jehudi son of Nethaniah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, to say to Baruch, "Bring the scroll from which You have been reading to the people and come." So Baruch son of Neriah went to them with the scroll in His hand.
- 15 *And they said unto him, Sit down now, and read it in our ears. So Baruch read it in their ears.* They said to Him, "Sit down, please, and read it to us." So Baruch read it to them.
- 16 *Now it came to pass, when they had heard all the words, they were afraid both one and other, and said unto Baruch, We will surely tell the king of all these words.* When they heard all these words, they looked at each other in fear and said to Baruch, "We must report all these words to the king."
- 17 *And they asked Baruch, saying, Tell us now, How didst thou write all these words at his mouth?* Then they asked Baruch, "Tell us, how did you come to write all this? Did Jeremiah dictate it?"
- 18 *Then Baruch answered them, He pronounced all these words unto me with his mouth, and I wrote them with ink in the book.* "Yes," Baruch replied, "he dictated all these words to me, and I wrote them in ink on the scroll."

- 19 *Then said the princes unto Baruch, Go, hide thee, thou and Jeremiah; and let no man know where ye be.* Then the officials said to Baruch, "You and Jeremiah must go and hide. Don't let anyone know where you are."
- 20 *And they went in to the king into the court, but they laid up the roll in the chamber of Elishama the scribe, and told all the words in the ears of the king.* After they put the scroll in the room of Elishama the secretary, they went to the king in the courtyard and reported everything to him.
- 21 *So the king sent Jehudi to fetch the roll: and he took it out of Elishama the scribe's chamber. And Jehudi read it in the ears of the king, and in the ears of all the princes which stood beside the king.* The king sent Jehudi to get the scroll, and Jehudi brought it from the room of Elishama the secretary and read it to the king and all the officials standing beside him.
- 22 *Now the king sat in the winterhouse in the ninth month: and there was a fire on the hearth burning before him.* It was the ninth month and the king was sitting in the winter apartment, with a fire burning in the firepot in front of him.
- 23 *And it came to pass, that when Jehudi had read three or four leaves, he cut it with the penknife, and cast it into the fire that was on the hearth, until all the roll was consumed in the fire that was on the hearth.* Whenever Jehudi had read three or four columns of the scroll, the king cut them off with a scribe's knife and threw them into the firepot, until the entire scroll was burned in the fire.
- 24 *Yet they were not afraid, nor rent their garments, neither the king, nor any of his servants that heard all these words.* The king and all his attendants who heard all these words showed no fear, nor did they tear their clothes.
- 25 *Nevertheless Elnathan and Delaiah and Gemariah had made intercession to the king that he would not burn the roll: but he would not hear them.* Even though Elnathan, Delaiah, and Gemariah urged the king not to burn the scroll, he would not listen to them.

- 26 *But the king commanded Jerahmeel the son of Hammelech, and Seraiah the son of Azriel, and Shelemiah the son of Abdeel, to take Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet: but the LORD hid them.* Instead, the king commanded Jerahmeel, a son of the king, Seraiah son of Azriel, and Shelemiah son of Abdeel to arrest Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet. But the LORD had hidden them.
- 27 *Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, after that the king had burned the roll, and the words which Baruch wrote at the mouth of Jeremiah, saying,* After the king burned the scroll containing the words that Baruch had written at Jeremiah's dictation, the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 28 *Take thee again another roll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first roll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah hath burned.* "Take another scroll and write on it all the words that were on the first scroll, which Jehoiakim king of Judah burned up.
- 29 *And thou shalt say to Jehoiakim king of Judah, Thus saith the LORD; Thou hast burned this roll, saying, Why hast thou written therein, saying, The king of Babylon shall certainly come and destroy this land, and shall cause to cease from thence man and beast?* Also tell Jehoiakim king of Judah, "This is what the LORD says: You burned that scroll and said, "Why did You write on it that the king of Babylon would certainly come and destroy this land and cut off both people and animals from it?"
- 30 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of Jehoiakim king of Judah; He shall have none to sit upon the throne of David: and his dead body shall be cast out in the day to the heat, and in the night to the frost.* Therefore this is what the LORD says about Jehoiakim king of Judah: He will have no one to sit on the throne of David. His body will be thrown out and exposed to the heat by day and the frost by night.
- 31 *And I will punish him and his seed and his servants for their iniquity; and I will bring upon them, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and upon the men of Judah, all the evil that I have pronounced against them; but they hearkened not.* I will punish Him and His children and His attendants for their wickedness. I will bring on them and those living in Jerusalem and the people of Judah every disaster I pronounced against them, because they have not listened.""

- 32 *Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: and there were added besides unto them many like words.* So Jeremiah took another scroll and gave it to the scribe Baruch son of Neriah. As Jeremiah dictated, Baruch wrote on it all the words of the scroll that Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire. And many similar words were added to them.

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 25:1
- v2 — Jer 30:2; Jer 1:10; Ex 17:14; Jer 36:6; Jer 25:3
- v3 — Jer 18:8; Acts 3:19; Jer 26:3; Deut 30:2
- v4 — Jer 32:12
- v7 — Jer 36:3
- v9 — 2 Chr 20:3
- v10 — Jer 36:11
- v12 — Jer 26:22
- v18 — Jer 36:4
- v22 — Amos 3:15
- v26 — 1 Kgs 19:1-3; 1 Kgs 19:14; Ps 91:1; 1 Kgs 19:10; 1 Kgs 17:3
- v32 — Jer 36:4; Jer 36:18

Chapter 37

King Zedekiah sent to Jeremiah asking him to pray for the nation. Jeremiah warned that the Chaldeans would return and burn the city. When Jeremiah tried to leave Jerusalem, he was arrested as a deserter and thrown into a dungeon. Zedekiah secretly brought him out and asked for a word from the LORD, and Jeremiah told him he would be delivered into the king of

Babylon's hand.

- 1 *And king Zedekiah the son of Josiah reigned instead of Coniah the son of Jehoiakim, whom Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon made king in the land of Judah.* Zedekiah son of Josiah was made king of Judah by Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. He reigned in place of Jehoiachin son of Jehoiakim.
- 2 *But neither he, nor his servants, nor the people of the land, did hearken unto the words of the LORD, which he spake by the prophet Jeremiah.* Neither He nor His attendants nor the people of the land paid any attention to the words the LORD had spoken through Jeremiah the prophet.
- 3 *And Zedekiah the king sent Jehucal the son of Shelemiah and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest to the prophet Jeremiah, saying, Pray now unto the LORD our God for us.* King Zedekiah, however, sent Jehucal son of Shelemiah with the priest Zephaniah son of Maaseiah to ask Jeremiah the prophet, "Please pray to the LORD our God for us."
- 4 *Now Jeremiah came in and went out among the people: for they had not put him into prison.* Now Jeremiah was free to come and go among the people, for he had not yet been put in prison.
- 5 *Then Pharaoh's army was come forth out of Egypt: and when the Chaldeans that besieged Jerusalem heard tidings of them, they departed from Jerusalem.* Pharaoh's army had marched out of Egypt, and when the Babylonians who were besieging Jerusalem heard the report about them, they withdrew from Jerusalem.
- 6 *Then came the word of the LORD unto the prophet Jeremiah, saying,* Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah the prophet:
- 7 *Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Thus shall ye say to the king of Judah, that sent you unto me to enquire of me; Behold, Pharaoh's army, which is come forth to help you, shall return to Egypt into their own land.* "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: Tell the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of Me: 'Pharaoh's army, which has marched out to support you, will go back to its own land of Egypt.'
- 8 *And the Chaldeans shall come again, and fight against this city, and take it, and burn it with fire.* Then the Babylonians will return and attack this city. They will capture it and burn it down.'

- 9 *Thus saith the LORD; Deceive not yourselves, saying, The Chaldeans shall surely depart from us: for they shall not depart.* "This is what the LORD says: Do not deceive yourselves, thinking, 'The Babylonians will surely leave us.' They will not!
- 10 *For though ye had smitten the whole army of the Chaldeans that fight against you, and there remained but wounded men among them, yet should they rise up every man in his tent, and burn this city with fire.* Even if You were to defeat the entire Babylonian army that is attacking You and only wounded men were left in their tents, they would still rise up and burn this city down."
- 11 *And it came to pass, that when the army of the Chaldeans was broken up from Jerusalem for fear of Pharaoh's army,* After the Babylonian army had withdrawn from Jerusalem because of Pharaoh's army,
- 12 *Then Jeremiah went forth out of Jerusalem to go into the land of Benjamin, to separate himself thence in the midst of the people.* Jeremiah started to leave the city to go to the territory of Benjamin to get his share of the property among the people there.
- 13 *And when he was in the gate of Benjamin, a captain of the ward was there, whose name was Irijah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Hananiah; and he took Jeremiah the prophet, saying, Thou fallest away to the Chaldeans.* But when he reached the Benjamin Gate, the captain of the guard, whose name was Irijah son of Shelemiah, the son of Hananiah, arrested him and said, "You are deserting to the Babylonians!"
- 14 *Then said Jeremiah, It is false; I fall not away to the Chaldeans. But he hearkened not to him: so Irijah took Jeremiah, and brought him to the princes.* "That's not true!" Jeremiah said. "I am not deserting to the Babylonians." But Irijah would not listen to him. Instead, he arrested Jeremiah and brought him to the officials.
- 15 *Wherefore the princes were wroth with Jeremiah, and smote him, and put him in prison in the house of Jonathan the scribe: for they had made that the prison.* They were angry with Jeremiah and had him beaten and imprisoned in the house of Jonathan the secretary, which they had made into a prison.

- 16 *When Jeremiah was entered into the dungeon, and into the cabins, and Jeremiah had remained there many days;* Jeremiah was put into a vaulted cell in a dungeon, where he remained a long time.
- 17 *Then Zedekiah the king sent, and took him out: and the king asked him secretly in his house, and said, Is there any word from the LORD? And Jeremiah said, There is: for, said he, thou shalt be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon.* Then King Zedekiah sent for him and had him brought to the palace, where He asked Him privately, "Is there any word from the LORD?" "Yes," Jeremiah replied, "you will be given into the hands of the king of Babylon."
- 18 *Moreover Jeremiah said unto king Zedekiah, What have I offended against thee, or against thy servants, or against this people, that ye have put me in prison?* Then Jeremiah said to King Zedekiah, "What crime have I committed against you, Your attendants, or this people, that You have put me in prison?"
- 19 *Where are now your prophets which prophesied unto you, saying, The king of Babylon shall not come against you, nor against this land?* Where are your prophets who prophesied to you, 'The king of Babylon will not attack you or this land'?
- 20 *Therefore hear now, I pray thee, O my lord the king: let my supplication, I pray thee, be accepted before thee; that thou cause me not to return to the house of Jonathan the scribe, lest I die there.* But now, my lord the king, please listen. Let my petition come before you. Please do not send me back to the house of Jonathan the secretary, or I will die there."
- 21 *Then Zedekiah the king commanded that they should commit Jeremiah into the court of the prison, and that they should give him daily a piece of bread out of the bakers' street, until all the bread in the city were spent. Thus Jeremiah remained in the court of the prison.* King Zedekiah then gave orders for Jeremiah to be placed in the courtyard of the guard and given bread from the street of the bakers each day until all the bread in the city was gone. So Jeremiah remained in the courtyard of the guard.

Words in this chapter:

Jonathan (*JON-ah-than*) — Saul's son and David's closest friend — showed remarkable loyalty to David even against his father's wishes; his name means 'the LORD has given.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 22:24; 2 Kgs 24:17

v3 — Jer 21:1-2

v5 — Ezek 17:15

v7 — Lam 4:17

v17 — Jer 21:7

v21 — Jer 38:13; Jer 38:28; Jer 38:9; Jer 52:6; Jer 32:2

Chapter 38

The princes cast Jeremiah into a muddy cistern to die because his words discouraged the soldiers. Ebedmelech the Ethiopian persuaded the king to rescue him, and Jeremiah was pulled out with ropes and rags. Zedekiah secretly consulted Jeremiah, who told him that if he surrendered to Babylon the city would not be burned and he would live, but Zedekiah feared the Jews who had already defected.

- 1 *Then Shephatiah the son of Mattan, and Gedaliah the son of Pashur, and Jucal the son of Shelemiah, and Pashur the son of Malchiah, heard the words that Jeremiah had spoken unto all the people, saying,* Shephatiah son of Mattan, Gedaliah son of Pashhur, Jehukal son of Shelemiah, and Pashhur son of Malkijah heard what Jeremiah had been telling all the people:
- 2 *Thus saith the LORD, He that remaineth in this city shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence: but he that goeth forth to the Chaldeans shall live; for he shall have his life for a prey, and shall live.* "This is what the LORD says: 'Whoever stays in this city will die by sword, famine, or plague. But whoever goes over to the Babylonians will live. They will escape with their lives.'
- 3 *Thus saith the LORD, This city shall surely be given into the hand of the king of Babylon's army, which shall take it.* This is what the LORD says: 'This city will certainly be given into the hands of the army of the king of Babylon, who will capture it.'

- 4 *Therefore the princes said unto the king, We beseech thee, let this man be put to death: for thus he weakeneth the hands of the men of war that remain in this city, and the hands of all the people, in speaking such words unto them: for this man seeketh not the welfare of this people, but the hurt.* Then the officials said to the king, "This man should be put to death. He is discouraging the soldiers who are left in this city, as well as all the people, by the things he is saying. He is not seeking the good of these people but their ruin."
- 5 *Then Zedekiah the king said, Behold, he is in your hand: for the king is not he that can do any thing against you.* "He is in your hands," King Zedekiah answered. "The king can do nothing to oppose you."
- 6 *Then took they Jeremiah, and cast him into the dungeon of Malchiah the son of Hammelech, that was in the court of the prison: and they let down Jeremiah with cords. And in the dungeon there was no water, but mire: so Jeremiah sunk in the mire.* So they took Jeremiah and put him into the cistern of Malkijah, the king's son, which was in the courtyard of the guard. They lowered Jeremiah by ropes into the cistern. There was no water in it, only mud, and Jeremiah sank down into the mud.
- 7 *Now when Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, one of the eunuchs which was in the king's house, heard that they had put Jeremiah in the dungeon; the king then sitting in the gate of Benjamin;* Now when Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, one of the eunuchs in the king's house, heard that they had put Jeremiah in the dungeon — the king was sitting in the gate of Benjamin —
- 8 *Ebed-melech went forth out of the king's house, and spake to the king, saying,* Ebed-Melech went out of the palace and said to him:
- 9 *My lord the king, these men have done evil in all that they have done to Jeremiah the prophet, whom they have cast into the dungeon; and he is like to die for hunger in the place where he is: for there is no more bread in the city.* "My lord the king, these men have acted wickedly in all they have done to Jeremiah the prophet. They have thrown him into a cistern, where he will starve to death when there is no longer any bread in the city."

- 10 *Then the king commanded Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, Take from hence thirty men with thee, and take up Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon, before he die.* Then the king commanded Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, "Take thirty men with you from here and lift Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon before he dies."
- 11 *So Ebed-melech took the men with him, and went into the house of the king under the treasury, and took thence old cast clouts and old rotten rags, and let them down by cords into the dungeon to Jeremiah.* So Ebed-Melech took the men with him and went to a room under the treasury in the palace. He took some old rags and worn-out clothes from there and lowered them by ropes to Jeremiah in the cistern.
- 12 *And Ebed-melech the Ethiopian said unto Jeremiah, Put now these old cast clouts and rotten rags under thine armholes under the cords. And Jeremiah did so.* Ebed-melech the Ethiopian said to Jeremiah, "Put now these old cast clouts and rotten rags under your armpits under the cords." And Jeremiah did so,
- 13 *So they drew up Jeremiah with cords, and took him up out of the dungeon: and Jeremiah remained in the court of the prison.* and they pulled him up with the ropes and lifted him out of the cistern. And Jeremiah remained in the courtyard of the guard.
- 14 *Then Zedekiah the king sent, and took Jeremiah the prophet unto him into the third entry that is in the house of the LORD: and the king said unto Jeremiah, I will ask thee a thing; hide nothing from me.* Then King Zedekiah sent for Jeremiah the prophet and had him brought to the third entrance to the temple of the LORD. "I am going to ask you something," the king said to Jeremiah. "Do not hide anything from me."
- 15 *Then Jeremiah said unto Zedekiah, If I declare it unto thee, wilt thou not surely put me to death? and if I give thee counsel, wilt thou not hearken unto me?* Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, "If I give you an answer, will you not kill me? Even if I do give you counsel, you will not listen to me."

- 16 *So Zedekiah the king swore secretly unto Jeremiah, saying, As the LORD liveth, that made us this soul, I will not put thee to death, neither will I give thee into the hand of these men that seek thy life.* But King Zedekiah swore this oath secretly to Jeremiah: "As surely as the LORD lives, who has given us breath, I will neither kill You nor hand You over to those who want to kill You."
- 17 *Then said Jeremiah unto Zedekiah, Thus saith the LORD, the God of hosts, the God of Israel; If thou wilt assuredly go forth unto the king of Babylon's princes, then thy soul shall live, and this city shall not be burned with fire; and thou shalt live, and thine house:* Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, "This is what the LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'If you surrender to the officers of the king of Babylon, your life will be spared and this city will not be burned down. You and your family will live.'
- 18 *But if thou wilt not go forth to the king of Babylon's princes, then shall this city be given into the hand of the Chaldeans, and they shall burn it with fire, and thou shalt not escape out of their hand.* But if you will not surrender to the officers of the king of Babylon, this city will be given into the hands of the Babylonians and they will burn it down. You yourself will not escape from their hands."
- 19 *And Zedekiah the king said unto Jeremiah, I am afraid of the Jews that are fallen to the Chaldeans, lest they deliver me into their hand, and they mock me.* King Zedekiah said to Jeremiah, "I am afraid of the Jews who have already gone over to the Babylonians. The Babylonians may hand me over to them and they will abuse me."
- 20 *But Jeremiah said, They shall not deliver thee. Obey, I beseech thee, the voice of the LORD, which I speak unto thee: so it shall be well unto thee, and thy soul shall live.* "They will not hand You over," Jeremiah replied. "Obey the LORD by doing what I tell You. Then it will go well with You and Your life will be spared.
- 21 *But if thou refuse to go forth, this is the word that the LORD hath shewed me:* But if You refuse to surrender, this is what the LORD has revealed to me:

- 22 *And, behold, all the women that are left in the king of Judah's house shall be brought forth to the king of Babylon's princes, and those women shall say, Thy friends have set thee on, and have prevailed against thee: thy feet are sunk in the mire, and they are turned away back.* All the women left in the palace of the king of Judah will be brought out to the officials of the king of Babylon. Those women will say to you: 'They misled you and overcame you — your trusted friends. Now that your feet are sunk in the mud, your friends have turned away.'
- 23 *So they shall bring out all thy wives and thy children to the Chaldeans: and thou shalt not escape out of their hand, but shalt be taken by the hand of the king of Babylon: and thou shalt cause this city to be burned with fire.* All your wives and children will be brought out to the Babylonians. You yourself will not escape from their hands but will be captured by the king of Babylon. And this city will be burned down."
- 24 *Then said Zedekiah unto Jeremiah, Let no man know of these words, and thou shalt not die.* Then Zedekiah said to Jeremiah, "Do not let anyone know about this conversation, or you may die.
- 25 *But if the princes hear that I have talked with thee, and they come unto thee, and say unto thee, Declare unto us now what thou hast said unto the king, hide it not from us, and we will not put thee to death; also what the king said unto thee:* If the officials hear that I talked with you, and they come to you and say, 'Tell us what you said to the king and what the king said to you — do not hide it from us or we will kill you' —
- 26 *Then thou shalt say unto them, I presented my supplication before the king, that he would not cause me to return to Jonathan's house, to die there.* then tell them, 'I was pleading with the king not to send me back to Jonathan's house to die there.'"
- 27 *Then came all the princes unto Jeremiah, and asked him: and he told them according to all these words that the king had commanded. So they left off speaking with him; for the matter was not perceived.* All the officials did come to Jeremiah and question him, and he told them everything the king had ordered him to say. So they said no more to him, for no one had heard his conversation with the king.

- 28

So Jeremiah abode in the court of the prison until the day that Jerusalem was taken: and he was there when Jerusalem was taken.
- And Jeremiah remained in the courtyard of the guard until the day Jerusalem was captured.

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 39:18
- v3 — Jer 21:10
- v4 — Jer 26:11
- v6 — Jer 37:21
- v7 — Amos 5:10
- v16 — Jer 37:17; Jer 38:1-6
- v17 — Jer 27:12; Jer 38:2; Jer 27:17; Jer 21:8-10; Jer 39:3
- v19 — John 12:42
- v20 — Dan 4:27
- v23 — Jer 41:10; Jer 39:6; Jer 38:18

Chapter 39

Nebuchadnezzar's army broke through the walls of Jerusalem in the eleventh year of Zedekiah. Zedekiah fled but was captured near Jericho; his sons were killed before his eyes, then his eyes were put out and he was bound in chains for Babylon. Nebuzaradan burned the city but released Jeremiah and commanded that he be treated well. The LORD promised Ebedmelech that his life would be spared.

- 1

In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the tenth month, came Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon and all his army against Jerusalem, and they besieged it.
- This is how Jerusalem was captured: In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the tenth month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched against Jerusalem with his whole army and laid siege to it.
- 2

And in the eleventh year of Zedekiah, in the fourth month, the ninth day of the month, the city was broken up.
- And on the ninth day of the fourth month of Zedekiah's eleventh year, the city wall was broken through.

- 3 *And all the princes of the king of Babylon came in, and sat in the middle gate, even Nergalsharezer, Samgarnebo, Sarsechim, Rabsaris, Nergalsharezer, Rabmag, with all the residue of the princes of the king of Babylon.* Then all the officials of the king of Babylon came and took seats in the Middle Gate: Nergal-Sharezer of Samgar, Nebo-Sarsekim a chief officer, Nergal-Sharezer a high official, and all the other officials of the king of Babylon.
- 4 *And it came to pass, that when Zedekiah the king of Judah saw them, and all the men of war, then they fled, and went forth out of the city by night, by the way of the king's garden, by the gate betwixt the two walls: and he went out the way of the plain.* When Zedekiah king of Judah and all the soldiers saw them, they fled. They left the city at night by way of the king's garden, through the gate between the two walls, and headed toward the Arabah.
- 5 *But the Chaldeans' army pursued after them, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho: and when they had taken him, they brought him up to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he gave judgment upon him.* But the Babylonian army pursued them and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho. They captured him and took him to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon at Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he pronounced sentence on him.
- 6 *Then the king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah in Riblah before his eyes: also the king of Babylon slew all the nobles of Judah.* There at Riblah the king of Babylon slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes. The king of Babylon also slaughtered all the nobles of Judah.
- 7 *Moreover he put out Zedekiah's eyes, and bound him with chains, to carry him to Babylon.* Then he gouged out Zedekiah's eyes and bound him with bronze shackles to take him to Babylon.
- 8 *And the Chaldeans burned the king's house, and the houses of the people, with fire, and brake down the walls of Jerusalem.* The Babylonians set fire to the royal palace and the houses of the people. They broke down the walls of Jerusalem.

- 9 *Then Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive into Babylon the remnant of the people that remained in the city, and those that fell away, that fell to him, with the rest of the people that remained.* Nebuzaradan commander of the imperial guard carried into exile to Babylon the people who remained in the city, along with those who had gone over to him and the rest of the people.
- 10 *But Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard left of the poor of the people, which had nothing, in the land of Judah, and gave them vineyards and fields at the same time.* But Nebuzaradan the commander of the guard left behind in the land of Judah some of the poor people, who owned nothing. At that time he gave them vineyards and fields.
- 11 *Now Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon gave charge concerning Jeremiah to Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard, saying,* Now Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had given these orders about Jeremiah through Nebuzaradan the commander of the guard:
- 12 *Take him, and look well to him, and do him no harm; but do unto him even as he shall say unto thee.* "Take him and look after him. Don't harm him but do for him whatever he asks."
- 13 *So Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard sent, and Nebushasban, Rabsaris, and Nergalsharezer, Rabmag, and all the king of Babylon's princes;* So Nebuzaradan the commander of the guard, Nebushazban a chief officer, Nergal-Sharezer a high official, and all the other officers of the king of Babylon
- 14 *Even they sent, and took Jeremiah out of the court of the prison, and committed him unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, that he should carry him home: so he dwelt among the people.* sent and had Jeremiah taken out of the courtyard of the guard. They turned him over to Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, to take him back to his home. So he remained among his own people.
- 15 *Now the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah, while he was shut up in the court of the prison, saying,* While Jeremiah had been confined in the courtyard of the guard, the word of the LORD had come to Him:

- 16 *Go and speak to Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring my words upon this city for evil, and not for good; and they shall be accomplished in that day before thee.* "Go and speak to Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, 'Thus says the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel: I will bring My words upon this city for evil and not for good. They shall be accomplished before You in that day.
- 17 *But I will deliver thee in that day, saith the LORD: and thou shalt not be given into the hand of the men of whom thou art afraid.* But I will rescue You on that day,' says the LORD. 'You will not be given into the hands of those You fear.
- 18 *For I will surely deliver thee, and thou shalt not fall by the sword, but thy life shall be for a prey unto thee: because thou hast put thy trust in me, saith the LORD.* I will save You. You will not fall by the sword but will escape with Your life, because You trust in Me,' says the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

- v5** — 2 Kgs 23:33
v7 — Ezek 12:13
v8 — Neh 1:3
v9 — Jer 40:1
v10 — 2 Kgs 25:12
v14 — Jer 38:28
v16 — Dan 9:12
v17 — Ps 41:1-2; Ps 50:15; Ps 91:14-15; 2 Sam 24:14; Jer 1:19
v18 — Jer 38:2; Ps 34:22; Jer 21:9; Eph 1:12; Ps 84:12

Chapter 40

Nebuzaradan released Jeremiah at Ramah and gave him the choice to go to Babylon or stay. Jeremiah chose to stay with Gedaliah, whom the king of Babylon had appointed governor over the remnant in Judah. Gedaliah gathered the scattered people and told them to serve the Chaldeans and it would be well with them, but Johanan warned Gedaliah that Ishmael planned

to murder him.

- ¹ *The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, after that Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had let him go from Ramah, when he had taken him being bound in chains among all that were carried away captive of Jerusalem and Judah, which were carried away captive unto Babylon.*

The word came to Jeremiah from the LORD after Nebuzaradan the commander of the guard had released Him at Ramah. He had found Jeremiah bound in chains among all the captives from Jerusalem and Judah who were being carried into exile to Babylon.
- ² *And the captain of the guard took Jeremiah, and said unto him, The LORD thy God hath pronounced this evil upon this place.*

When the commander of the guard found Jeremiah, he said to him: "The LORD Your God decreed this disaster for this place.
- ³ *Now the LORD hath brought it, and done according as he hath said: because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed his voice, therefore this thing is come upon you.*

And the LORD has brought it about. He has done just as He said He would. All this happened because You people sinned against the LORD and did not obey Him.
- ⁴ *And now, behold, I loose thee this day from the chains which were upon thine hand. If it seem good unto thee to come with me into Babylon, come; and I will look well unto thee: but if it seem ill unto thee to come with me into Babylon, forbear: behold, all the land is before thee: whither it seemeth good and convenient for thee to go, thither go.*

But today I am freeing You from the chains on Your wrists. Come with me to Babylon, if You like, and I will look after You. But if You do not want to come, then don't. See, the whole land lies before You. Go wherever You please."

- 5 *Now while he was not yet gone back, he said, Go back also to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon hath made governor over the cities of Judah, and dwell with him among the people: or go wheresoever it seemeth convenient unto thee to go. So the captain of the guard gave him victuals and a reward, and let him go.* But before Jeremiah turned to go, Nebuzaradan added, "Go back to Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon has appointed over the towns of Judah, and live with him among the people, or go anywhere else you please." Then the commander gave him provisions and a present and let him go.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gedaliah** (ged-uh-LY-uh) — "the LORD is great" — appointed governor over the remaining people of Judah after the fall of Jerusalem. He was assassinated not long after taking office (Jeremiah 41).

- 6 *So Jeremiah went unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and dwelt with him among the people that were left in the land.* So Jeremiah went to Gedaliah son of Ahikam at Mizpah and stayed with Him among the people who were left behind in the land.
- 7 *Now when all the captains of the forces which were in the fields, even they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam governor in the land, and had committed unto him men, and women, and children, and of the poor of the land, of them that were not carried away captive to Babylon;* When all the army officers and their men who were still in the open country heard that the king of Babylon had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam as governor over the land and had put him in charge of the men, women, and children who were the poorest in the land and had not been carried into exile to Babylon,
- 8 *Then they came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and Johanan and Jonathan the sons of Kareah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth, and the sons of Ephai the Netophathite, and Jezaniah the son of a Maachathite, they and their men.* they came to Gedaliah at Mizpah — Ishmael son of Nethaniah, Johanan and Jonathan the sons of Kareah, Seraiah son of Tanhumeth, the sons of Ephai the Netophathite, and Jezaniah son of the Maachathite, and their men.

- 9 *And Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan sware unto them and to their men, saying, Fear not to serve the Chaldeans: dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it shall be well with you.* Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, took an oath to reassure them and their men. "Do not be afraid to serve the Babylonians," he said. "Live in the land and serve the king of Babylon, and it will go well with you.
- 10 *As for me, behold, I will dwell at Mizpah, to serve the Chaldeans, which will come unto us: but ye, gather ye wine, and summer fruits, and oil, and put them in your vessels, and dwell in your cities that ye have taken.* I myself will stay at Mizpah to represent you before the Babylonians who come to us. You are to harvest the wine, summer fruit, and olive oil, and put them in your storage jars. Live in the towns you have taken over."
- 11 *Likewise when all the Jews that were in Moab, and among the Ammonites, and in Edom, and that were in all the countries, heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant of Judah, and that he had set over them Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan;* When all the Jews in Moab, Ammon, Edom, and all the other countries heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant in Judah and had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, over them,
- 12 *Then they returned out of all places whither they were driven, even Judah, to Gedaliah, unto Mizpah, and gathered wine and summer fruits very much.* they all came back to the land of Judah, to Gedaliah at Mizpah, from all the countries where they had been scattered. And they harvested an abundance of wine and summer fruit.
- 13 *Moreover Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were in the fields, came to Gedaliah to Mizpah,* Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers still in the open country came to Gedaliah at Mizpah

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| <p>14 <i>And said unto him, Dost thou certainly know that Baalis the king of the Ammonites hath sent Ishmael the son of Nethaniah to slay thee? But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam believed them not.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Then Johanan the son of Kareah spake to Gedaliah in Mizpah secretly, saying, Let me go, I pray thee, and I will slay Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and no man shall know it: wherefore should he slay thee, that all the Jews which are gathered unto thee should be scattered, and the remnant in Judah perish?</i></p> <p>16 <i>But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam said unto Johanan the son of Kareah, Thou shalt not do this thing: for thou speakest falsely of Ishmael.</i></p> | <p>and said to him, "Don't you know that Baalis king of Ammon has sent Ishmael son of Nethaniah to take your life?" But Gedaliah son of Ahikam did not believe them.</p> <p>Then Johanan son of Kareah said privately to Gedaliah in Mizpah, "Let me go and kill Ishmael son of Nethaniah, and no one will know it. Why should he take your life and cause all the Jews who have gathered around you to be scattered, and the remnant of Judah to perish?"</p> <p>But Gedaliah son of Ahikam said to Johanan son of Kareah, "Don't do such a thing! What you are saying about Ishmael is not true."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

victuals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Ishmael (*ISH-mee-el*) — Abraham's son by Hagar — the angel promised he would be a 'wild man' whose hand would be against every man; ancestor of the Arab peoples.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Deut 29:24-28
- v3 — Rom 2:5
- v4 — Jer 39:11-12
- v5 — Jer 39:14
- v7 — Jer 39:10
- v8 — Jer 42:1
- v10 — Jer 40:12
- v14 — Jer 41:10

Chapter 41

Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, of the royal family, came to Gedaliah at Mizpah and murdered him along with the Jews and Chaldean soldiers who were with him. He killed seventy of eighty men who came from Shechem, Shiloh, and Samaria, and took the remnant captive. Johanan and his forces pursued Ishmael and rescued the captives, but Ishmael escaped to the Ammonites.

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| 1 | <i>Now it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah the son of Elishama, of the seed royal, and the princes of the king, even ten men with him, came unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and there they did eat bread together in Mizpah.</i> | In the seventh month, Ishmael son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, who was of royal blood and had been one of the king's officers, came with ten men to Gedaliah son of Ahikam at Mizpah. While they were eating together there, |
| 2 | <i>Then arose Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and the ten men that were with him, and smote Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan with the sword, and slew him, whom the king of Babylon had made governor over the land.</i> | Ishmael son of Nethaniah and the ten men who were with him rose up and struck down Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, with the sword, killing the one whom the king of Babylon had appointed as governor over the land. |
| 3 | <i>Ishmael also slew all the Jews that were with him, even with Gedaliah, at Mizpah, and the Chaldeans that were found there, and the men of war.</i> | Ishmael also killed all the Jews who were with Gedaliah at Mizpah, as well as the Babylonian soldiers who were there. |
| 4 | <i>And it came to pass the second day after he had slain Gedaliah, and no man knew it,</i> | The day after Gedaliah's assassination, before anyone knew about it, |
| 5 | <i>That there came certain from Shechem, from Shiloh, and from Samaria, even fourscore men, having their beards shaven, and their clothes rent, and having cut themselves, with offerings and incense in their hand, to bring them to the house of the LORD.</i> | eighty men who had shaved off their beards, torn their clothes, and cut themselves came from Shechem, Shiloh, and Samaria. They were bringing grain offerings and incense to the house of the LORD. |

- 6 *And Ishmael the son of Nethaniah went forth from Mizpah to meet them, weeping all along as he went: and it came to pass, as he met them, he said unto them, Come to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam.* Ishmael son of Nethaniah went out from Mizpah to meet them, weeping as He went. When He met them, He said, "Come to Gedaliah son of Ahikam."
- 7 *And it was so, when they came into the midst of the city, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah slew them, and cast them into the midst of the pit, he, and the men that were with him.* When they came into the city, Ishmael son of Nethaniah and the men with Him slaughtered them and threw them into a cistern.
- 8 *But ten men were found among them that said unto Ishmael, Slay us not: for we have treasures in the field, of wheat, and of barley, and of oil, and of honey. So he forbore, and slew them not among their brethren.* But ten of them said to Ishmael, "Don't kill us! We have wheat, barley, olive oil, and honey hidden in a field." So He let them alone and did not kill them with the others.
- 9 *Now the pit wherein Ishmael had cast all the dead bodies of the men, whom he had slain because of Gedaliah, was it which Asa the king had made for fear of Baasha king of Israel: and Ishmael the son of Nethaniah filled it with them that were slain.* Now the cistern where he threw all the bodies of the men he had killed was the large cistern that King Asa had made as part of his defense against Baasha king of Israel. Ishmael son of Nethaniah filled it with the dead.
- 10 *Then Ishmael carried away captive all the residue of the people that were in Mizpah, even the king's daughters, and all the people that remained in Mizpah, whom Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had committed to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam: and Ishmael the son of Nethaniah carried them away captive, and departed to go over to the children of Ammon.* Ishmael made captives of all the rest of the people who were in Mizpah — the king's daughters along with all the others who were left there, over whom Nebuzaradan commander of the imperial guard had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam. Ishmael son of Nethaniah took them captive and set out to cross over to Ammon.

- 11 *But when Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, heard of all the evil that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had done,* When Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers with him heard about all the crimes Ishmael son of Nethaniah had committed,
- 12 *Then they took all the men, and went to fight with Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and found him by the great waters that are in Gibeon.* they took all their men and went to fight Ishmael son of Nethaniah. They caught up with him near the great pool in Gibeon.
- 13 *Now it came to pass, that when all the people which were with Ishmael saw Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, then they were glad.* When all the people Ishmael had with him saw Johanan son of Kareah and the army officers with him, they were glad.
- 14 *So all the people that Ishmael had carried away captive from Mizpah cast about and returned, and went unto Johanan the son of Kareah.* All the people Ishmael had taken captive at Mizpah turned around and came over to Johanan son of Kareah.
- 15 *But Ishmael the son of Nethaniah escaped from Johanan with eight men, and went to the children of Ammon.* But Ishmael son of Nethaniah and eight of his men escaped from Johanan and fled to Ammon.
- 16 *Then took Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, all the remnant of the people whom he had recovered from Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, from Mizpah, after that he had slain Gedaliah the son of Ahikam; even mighty men of war, and the women, and the children, and the eunuchs, whom he had brought again from Gibeon:* Then Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers with him led away all the survivors from Mizpah who had been recovered from Ishmael son of Nethaniah after he had assassinated Gedaliah son of Ahikam — the soldiers, women, children, and court officials he had brought from Gibeon.
- 17 *And they departed, and dwelt in the habitation of Chimham, which is by Bethlehem, to go to enter into Egypt,* And they went on, stopping at Geruth Kimham near Bethlehem on their way to Egypt

- 18 *Because of the Chaldeans: for they were afraid of them, because Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had slain Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon made governor in the land.* to escape from the Babylonians. They were afraid of them because Ishmael son of Nethaniah had killed Gedaliah son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon had appointed as governor over the land.

Words in this chapter:

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 40:8
 v2 — 2 Kgs 25:25
 v5 — 1 Kgs 16:24; 2 Kgs 25:9; Josh 18:1; Deut 14:1
 v10 — Jer 40:14
 v12 — 2 Sam 2:13
 v18 — Jer 40:5

Chapter 42

Johanan and the remnant asked Jeremiah to pray and inquire of the LORD whether they should stay in Judah or go to Egypt, swearing to obey whatever the LORD said. After ten days the LORD answered: if they stayed in the land He would build them up and plant them, but if they went to Egypt the sword and famine they feared would follow them there, and they would die.

- 1 *Then all the captains of the forces, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and Jezaniah the son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least even unto the greatest, came near,* Then all the army officers, including Johanan son of Kareah and Jezaniah son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least to the greatest approached
- 2 *And said unto Jeremiah the prophet, Let, we beseech thee, our supplication be accepted before thee, and pray for us unto the LORD thy God, even for all this remnant; (for we are left but a few of many, as thine eyes do behold us:)* and said to Jeremiah the prophet, "Please hear our petition and pray to the LORD your God for this entire remnant. For as you now see, though we were once many, now only a few are left.

- 3 *That the LORD thy God may shew us the way wherein we may walk, and the thing that we may do.* Pray that the LORD Your God will tell us where we should go and what we should do."
- 4 *Then Jeremiah the prophet said unto them, I have heard you; behold, I will pray unto the LORD your God according to your words; and it shall come to pass, that whatsoever thing the LORD shall answer you, I will declare it unto you; I will keep nothing back from you.* "I have heard You," replied Jeremiah the prophet. "I will certainly pray to the LORD Your God as You have requested. I will tell You everything the LORD says and will keep nothing back from You."
- 5 *Then they said to Jeremiah, The LORD be a true and faithful witness between us, if we do not even according to all things for the which the LORD thy God shall send thee to us.* Then they said to Jeremiah, "May the LORD be a true and faithful witness against us if we do not act in accordance with everything the LORD Your God sends You to tell us."
- 6 *Whether it be good, or whether it be evil, we will obey the voice of the LORD our God, to whom we send thee; that it may be well with us, when we obey the voice of the LORD our God.* Whether it is favorable or unfavorable, we will obey the LORD our God, to whom we are sending You, so that it will go well with us, for we will obey the LORD our God."
- 7 *And it came to pass after ten days, that the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah.* Ten days later the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah.
- 8 *Then called he Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces which were with him, and all the people from the least even to the greatest,* So He called together Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers who were with Him and all the people from the least to the greatest.
- 9 *And said unto them, Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, unto whom ye sent me to present your supplication before him:* He said to them: "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, to whom You sent me to present Your petition, says:

- 10 *If ye will still abide in this land, then will I build you, and not pull you down, and I will plant you, and not pluck you up: for I repent me of the evil that I have done unto you.* 'If You stay in this land, I will build You up and not tear You down. I will plant You and not uproot You, for I am grieved over the disaster I have inflicted on You.
- 11 *Be not afraid of the king of Babylon, of whom ye are afraid; be not afraid of him, saith the LORD: for I am with you to save you, and to deliver you from his hand.* Do not be afraid of the king of Babylon, whom you now fear. Do not be afraid of Him,' says the LORD, 'for I am with You and will save You and deliver You from His hands.
- 12 *And I will shew mercies unto you, that he may have mercy upon you, and cause you to return to your own land.* I will show You compassion so that He will have compassion on You and restore You to Your land.'
- 13 *But if ye say, We will not dwell in this land, neither obey the voice of the LORD your God,* But if You say, 'We will not stay in this land,' and so disobey the LORD Your God,
- 14 *Saying, No, but we will go into the land of Egypt, where we shall see no war, nor hear the sound of the trumpet, nor have hunger of bread; and there will we dwell:* and if You say, 'No, we will go and live in Egypt, where we will not see war or hear the trumpet or be hungry for bread,'
- 15 *And now therefore hear the word of the LORD, ye remnant of Judah; Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; If ye wholly set your faces to enter into Egypt, and go to sojourn there;* then hear the word of the LORD, You remnant of Judah. This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'If You are determined to go to Egypt and You do go to settle there,
- 16 *Then it shall come to pass, that the sword, which ye feared, shall overtake you there in the land of Egypt, and the famine, whereof ye were afraid, shall follow close after you there in Egypt; and there ye shall die.* then the sword You fear will overtake You there, and the famine You dread will follow You into Egypt, and there You will die.

- 17 *So shall it be with all the men that set their faces to go into Egypt to sojourn there; they shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence: and none of them shall remain or escape from the evil that I will bring upon them.* Indeed, all who are determined to go to Egypt to settle there will die by sword, famine, and plague. Not one of them will survive or escape the disaster I will bring on them.'
- 18 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; As mine anger and my fury hath been poured forth upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem; so shall my fury be poured forth upon you, when ye shall enter into Egypt: and ye shall be an execration, and an astonishment, and a curse, and a reproach; and ye shall see this place no more.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Just as My anger and wrath have been poured out on those who lived in Jerusalem, so will My wrath be poured out on You when You go to Egypt. You will be a curse and an object of horror, a curse and a disgrace. You will never see this place again.'
- 19 *The LORD hath said concerning you, O ye remnant of Judah; Go ye not into Egypt: know certainly that I have admonished you this day.* The LORD has told You, You remnant of Judah, 'Do not go to Egypt.' Be sure of this: I warn You today
- 20 *For ye dissembled in your hearts, when ye sent me unto the LORD your God, saying, Pray for us unto the LORD our God; and according unto all that the LORD our God shall say, so declare unto us, and we will do it.* that You made a fatal mistake when You sent me to the LORD Your God and said, 'Pray to the LORD our God for us. Tell us everything He says and we will do it.'
- 21 *And now I have this day declared it to you; but ye have not obeyed the voice of the LORD your God, nor any thing for the which he hath sent me unto you.* I have told You today, but You still have not obeyed the LORD Your God in all He sent me to tell You.

- 22 *Now therefore know certainly that ye shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, in the place whither ye desire to go and to sojourn.* So now, be sure of this: You will die by sword, famine, and plague in the place where You want to go and settle."

Words in this chapter:

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 41:11; Jer 40:13; Jer 6:13
- v2** — Jer 36:7; Lev 26:22
- v3** — Ps 86:11; Prov 3:6
- v4** — 1 Sam 3:17-18; Ps 40:10; 1 Sam 12:23; Ex 8:29
- v5** — Gen 31:50; Judg 11:10
- v8** — Jer 42:1
- v9** — 2 Kgs 19:6; 2 Kgs 19:4; Jer 42:2
- v10** — Jer 24:6; Ezek 36:36; Jer 31:28; Joel 2:13; Jer 33:7
- v11** — Rom 8:31; Isa 43:2; Jer 1:19; Jer 1:8; 2 Chr 32:7-8
- v12** — Ps 106:45-46; Prov 16:7; Neh 1:11
- v13** — Jer 44:16
- v16** — Jer 44:27; Ezek 11:8

Chapter 43

Johanan and the proud men accused Jeremiah of lying and refused to obey the LORD's command to remain in Judah. They took the entire remnant, including Jeremiah and Baruch, and went down to Egypt. At Tahpanhes the LORD told Jeremiah to hide stones in the clay at the brickworks, for Nebuchadnezzar would set his throne over them and strike the land of Egypt.

- 1 *And it came to pass, that when Jeremiah had made an end of speaking unto all the people all the words of the LORD their God, for which the LORD their God had sent him to them, even all these words,* When Jeremiah finished telling the people all the words of the LORD their God — everything the LORD had sent Him to tell them —
- 2 *Then spake Azariah the son of Hoshaiiah, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the proud men, saying unto Jeremiah, Thou speakest falsely: the LORD our God hath not sent thee to say, Go not into Egypt to sojourn there:* Azariah son of Hoshaiiah and Johanan son of Kareah and all the arrogant men said to Jeremiah, "You are lying! The LORD our God has not sent you to say, 'You must not go to Egypt to settle there.'
- 3 *But Baruch the son of Neriah setteth thee on against us, for to deliver us into the hand of the Chaldeans, that they might put us to death, and carry us away captives into Babylon.* But Baruch son of Neriah is inciting You against us to hand us over to the Babylonians, so they may kill us or carry us into exile to Babylon."
- 4 *So Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, and all the people, obeyed not the voice of the LORD, to dwell in the land of Judah.* So Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers and all the people disobeyed the LORD's command to stay in the land of Judah.
- 5 *But Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, took all the remnant of Judah, that were returned from all nations, whither they had been driven, to dwell in the land of Judah;* Instead, Johanan son of Kareah and all the army officers led away all the remnant of Judah who had come back to live in the land of Judah from all the nations where they had been scattered.
- 6 *Even men, and women, and children, and the king's daughters, and every person that Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had left with Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Jeremiah the prophet, and Baruch the son of Neriah.* They included men, women, and children, the king's daughters, and everyone Nebuzaradan commander of the imperial guard had left with Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan — and also Jeremiah the prophet and Baruch son of Neriah.

- 7 *So they came into the land of Egypt: for they obeyed not the voice of the LORD: thus came they even to Tahpanhes.* So they entered Egypt in disobedience to the LORD and went as far as Tahpanhes.
- 8 *Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah in Tahpanhes, saying,* In Tahpanhes the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah:
- 9 *Take great stones in thine hand, and hide them in the clay in the brickwork, which is at the entry of Pharaoh's house in Tahpanhes, in the sight of the men of Judah;* "While the Jews are watching, take some large stones with you and bury them in clay in the brick pavement at the entrance to Pharaoh's palace in Tahpanhes.
- 10 *And say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will send and take Nebuchadrezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will set his throne upon these stones that I have hid; and he shall spread his royal pavilion over them.* Then say to them, "This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: I will send for My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and I will set his throne over these stones I have buried here. He will spread His royal canopy above them.
- 11 *And when he cometh, he shall smite the land of Egypt, and deliver such as are for death to death; and such as are for captivity to captivity; and such as are for the sword to the sword.* He will come and attack Egypt, bringing death to those destined for death, captivity to those destined for captivity, and the sword to those destined for the sword.
- 12 *And I will kindle a fire in the houses of the gods of Egypt; and he shall burn them, and carry them away captives: and he shall array himself with the land of Egypt, as a shepherd putteth on his garment; and he shall go forth from thence in peace.* He will set fire to the temples of the gods of Egypt. He will burn their temples and take their gods captive. As a shepherd wraps His garment around Him, so He will wrap Egypt around Himself and depart from there unharmed.
- 13 *He shall break also the images of Bethshemesh, that is in the land of Egypt; and the houses of the gods of Egypt shall he burn with fire.* There in the temple of the sun in Egypt He will demolish the sacred pillars and will burn down the temples of the gods of Egypt."

Words in this chapter:

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

v6 — Jer 39:10

v7 — Jer 44:1; Jer 2:16

v10 — Isa 44:28-45:1

v11 — Jer 15:2; Jer 44:13

v12 — Ezek 30:13; Ps 109:18-19; Isa 49:18; Isa 19:1

Chapter 44

Jeremiah warned the Jews in Egypt that the LORD's anger had burned against Jerusalem because of their idolatry, and now they were provoking Him again by burning incense to the queen of heaven in Egypt. The people defiantly refused to listen, insisting they would continue their offerings to the queen of heaven. The LORD declared that the remnant in Egypt would be consumed by sword and famine.

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| <p>1 <i>The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews which dwell in the land of Egypt, which dwell at Migdol, and at Tahpanhes, and at Noph, and in the country of Pathros, saying,</i></p> | <p>This word came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews living in Lower Egypt — in Migdol, Tahpanhes, and Memphis — and in Upper Egypt:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Ye have seen all the evil that I have brought upon Jerusalem, and upon all the cities of Judah; and, behold, this day they are a desolation, and no man dwelleth therein,</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: You saw the disaster I brought on Jerusalem and on all the towns of Judah. Today they lie deserted and in ruins</p> |

- 3 *Because of their wickedness which they have committed to provoke me to anger, in that they went to burn incense, and to serve other gods, whom they knew not, neither they, nor you, nor your fathers.* because of the evil they did to arouse My anger, in that they went to burn incense and to worship other gods that neither they nor You nor Your ancestors ever knew.
- 4 *Howbeit I sent unto you all my servants the prophets, rising early and sending them, saying, Oh, do not this abominable thing that I hate.* Again and again I sent My servants the prophets, who said, 'Do not do this detestable thing that I hate!'
- 5 *But they hearkened not, nor inclined their ear to turn from their wickedness, to burn no incense unto other gods.* But they did not listen or pay attention. They did not turn from their wickedness or stop burning incense to other gods.
- 6 *Wherefore my fury and mine anger was poured forth, and was kindled in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; and they are wasted and desolate, as at this day.* Therefore My fierce anger was poured out. It raged against the towns of Judah and the streets of Jerusalem and made them the desolate ruins they are today.
- 7 *Therefore now thus saith the LORD, the God of hosts, the God of Israel; Wherefore commit ye this great evil against your souls, to cut off from you man and woman, child and suckling, out of Judah, to leave you none to remain;* "Now this is what the LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, says: Why bring such great disaster on yourselves by cutting off from Judah the men and women, the children and infants, and so leave yourselves without a remnant?
- 8 *In that ye provoke me unto wrath with the works of your hands, burning incense unto other gods in the land of Egypt, whither ye be gone to dwell, that ye might cut yourselves off, and that ye might be a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the earth?* Why arouse My anger with what Your hands have made, burning incense to other gods in Egypt, where You have come to live? You will destroy yourselves and make yourselves a curse and a disgrace among all the nations on earth.

- 9 *Have ye forgotten the wickedness of your fathers, and the wickedness of the kings of Judah, and the wickedness of their wives, and your own wickedness, and the wickedness of your wives, which they have committed in the land of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem?* Have You forgotten the wickedness committed by Your ancestors and by the kings and queens of Judah and the wickedness committed by You and Your wives in the land of Judah and on the streets of Jerusalem?
- 10 *They are not humbled even unto this day, neither have they feared, nor walked in my law, nor in my statutes, that I set before you and before your fathers.* To this day they have not humbled themselves or shown reverence, nor have they followed My law and the decrees I set before You and Your ancestors.
- 11 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will set my face against you for evil, and to cut off all Judah.* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: I am determined to bring disaster on You and to destroy all Judah.
- 12 *And I will take the remnant of Judah, that have set their faces to go into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, and they shall all be consumed, and fall in the land of Egypt; they shall even be consumed by the sword and by the famine: they shall die, from the least even unto the greatest, by the sword and by the famine: and they shall be an execration, and an astonishment, and a curse, and a reproach.* I will take away the remnant of Judah who were determined to go to Egypt to settle there. They will all perish in Egypt. They will fall by the sword or die from famine. From the least to the greatest, they will die by sword or famine. They will become a curse and an object of horror, a curse and a disgrace.
- 13 *For I will punish them that dwell in the land of Egypt, as I have punished Jerusalem, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence:* I will punish those who live in Egypt with sword, famine, and plague, just as I punished Jerusalem.

- 14 *So that none of the remnant of Judah, which are gone into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, shall escape or remain, that they should return into the land of Judah, to the which they have a desire to return to dwell there: for none shall return but such as shall escape.* None of the remnant of Judah who have gone to live in Egypt will escape or survive to return to the land of Judah, to which they long to return and live. None will return except a few fugitives."
- 15 *Then all the men which knew that their wives had burned incense unto other gods, and all the women that stood by, a great congregation, even all the people that dwelt in the land of Egypt, in Pathros, answered Jeremiah, saying,* Then all the men who knew that their wives were burning incense to other gods, along with all the women who were present — a large assembly — and all the people living in Lower and Upper Egypt, said to Jeremiah:
- 16 *As for the word that thou hast spoken unto us in the name of the LORD, we will not hearken unto thee.* "We will not listen to the message You have spoken to us in the name of the LORD!
- 17 *But we will certainly do whatsoever thing goeth forth out of our own mouth, to burn incense unto the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her, as we have done, we, and our fathers, our kings, and our princes, in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem: and then had we plenty of victuals, and were well, and saw no evil.* We will certainly carry out every word that has come from our own mouths. We will burn incense to the Queen of Heaven and will pour out drink offerings to her just as we and our ancestors, our kings and our officials did in the towns of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem. At that time we had plenty of food and were well off and suffered no harm.
- 18 *But since we left off to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her, we have wanted all things, and have been consumed by the sword and by the famine.* But ever since we stopped burning incense to the Queen of Heaven and pouring out drink offerings to her, we have had nothing and have been perishing by sword and famine."

- 19 *And when we burned incense to the queen of heaven, and poured out drink offerings unto her, did we make her cakes to worship her, and pour out drink offerings unto her, without our men?* The women added, "When we burned incense to the Queen of Heaven and poured out drink offerings to her, did we make cakes impressed with her image and pour out drink offerings to her without our husbands knowing it?"
- 20 *Then Jeremiah said unto all the people, to the men, and to the women, and to all the people which had given him that answer, saying,* Then Jeremiah said to all the people, both men and women, who were answering him:
- 21 *The incense that ye burned in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, ye, and your fathers, your kings, and your princes, and the people of the land, did not the LORD remember them, and came it not into his mind?* "Did not the LORD remember and call to mind the incense burned in the towns of Judah and the streets of Jerusalem by You and Your ancestors, Your kings and Your officials and the people of the land?
- 22 *So that the LORD could no longer bear, because of the evil of your doings, and because of the abominations which ye have committed; therefore is your land a desolation, and an astonishment, and a curse, without an inhabitant, as at this day.* When the LORD could no longer endure Your wicked actions and the detestable things You did, Your land became a curse and a desolate waste without inhabitants, as it is today.
- 23 *Because ye have burned incense, and because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed the voice of the LORD, nor walked in his law, nor in his statutes, nor in his testimonies; therefore this evil is happened unto you, as at this day.* This disaster came on You because You burned incense and sinned against the LORD and did not obey the LORD or follow His law, His decrees, or His stipulations. That is why this disaster has come upon You, as You now see."

- 24 *Moreover Jeremiah said unto all the people, and to all the women, Hear the word of the LORD, all Judah that are in the land of Egypt:* Then Jeremiah said to all the people, including the women, "Hear the word of the LORD, all You people of Judah in Egypt.
- 25 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying; Ye and your wives have both spoken with your mouths, and fulfilled with your hand, saying, We will surely perform our vows that we have vowed, to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her: ye will surely accomplish your vows, and surely perform your vows.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: You and Your wives have done what You said You would do when You promised, 'We will certainly carry out the vows we made to burn incense and pour out drink offerings to the Queen of Heaven.' Go ahead then, do what you promised! Keep Your vows!
- 26 *Therefore hear ye the word of the LORD, all Judah that dwell in the land of Egypt; Behold, I have sworn by my great name, saith the LORD, that my name shall no more be named in the mouth of any man of Judah in all the land of Egypt, saying, The Lord GOD liveth.* But hear the word of the LORD, all Jews living in Egypt: 'I swear by My great name,' says the LORD, 'that no one from Judah living anywhere in Egypt will ever again invoke My name or swear, "As surely as the Lord GOD lives."
- 27 *Behold, I will watch over them for evil, and not for good: and all the men of Judah that are in the land of Egypt shall be consumed by the sword and by the famine, until there be an end of them.* For I am watching over them for harm, not for good. The Jews in Egypt will perish by sword and famine until they are all destroyed.
- 28 *Yet a small number that escape the sword shall return out of the land of Egypt into the land of Judah, and all the remnant of Judah, that are gone into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, shall know whose words shall stand, mine, or theirs.* Those who escape the sword and return to the land of Judah from Egypt will be very few. Then the whole remnant of Judah who came to live in Egypt will know whose word will stand — Mine or theirs.

- 29 *And this shall be a sign unto you, saith the LORD, that I will punish you in this place, that ye may know that my words shall surely stand against you for evil:* This will be the sign to You that I will punish You in this place,' says the LORD, 'so that You will know that My threats of harm against You will surely come true':
- 30 *Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give Pharaohhophra king of Egypt into the hand of his enemies, and into the hand of them that seek his life; as I gave Zedekiah king of Judah into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, his enemy, and that sought his life.* 'I am going to give Pharaoh Hophra king of Egypt into the hands of his enemies who want to kill him, just as I gave Zedekiah king of Judah into the hands of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, the enemy who wanted to kill him.'"

Words in this chapter:

victuals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 46:14; Isa 11:11; Ex 14:2
- v3** — Deut 29:26
- v4** — Jer 26:5
- v7** — Hab 2:10; Jer 51:22
- v8** — Jer 42:18; Jer 44:3; Jer 25:6-7
- v10** — Prov 28:14
- v11** — Jer 21:10
- v17** — Jer 7:18; Neh 9:34
- v18** — Mal 3:13-15
- v19** — Jer 7:18
- v21** — Jer 44:17
- v23** — Dan 9:11-12; 1 Kgs 9:9

Chapter 45

The LORD gave Jeremiah a personal word for Baruch the scribe, who had complained of his sorrow and weariness. The LORD told Baruch that He was about to tear down what He had built and uproot what He had planted over the whole land. He warned Baruch not to seek great things for himself, but promised that his life would be given to him as a prize wherever he went.

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| <p>1 <i>The word that Jeremiah the prophet spake unto Baruch the son of Neriah, when he had written these words in a book at the mouth of Jeremiah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, saying,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, unto thee, O Baruch;</i></p> <p>3 <i>Thou didst say, Woe is me now! for the LORD hath added grief to my sorrow; I fainted in my sighing, and I find no rest.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Thus shalt thou say unto him, The LORD saith thus; Behold, that which I have built will I break down, and that which I have planted I will pluck up, even this whole land.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And seekest thou great things for thyself? seek them not: for, behold, I will bring evil upon all flesh, saith the LORD: but thy life will I give unto thee for a prey in all places whither thou goest.</i></p> | <p>This is the word that Jeremiah the prophet spoke to Baruch son of Neriah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah, after Baruch had written on a scroll the words Jeremiah dictated. He said:</p> <p>"This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says to You, Baruch:</p> <p>You said, 'Woe to me! The LORD has added sorrow to my pain. I am worn out with groaning and find no rest.'</p> <p>But the LORD says: 'I will overthrow what I have built and uproot what I have planted — this entire land.</p> <p>Should You then seek great things for Yourself? Do not seek them. For I will bring disaster on all people,' says the LORD, 'but wherever You go I will let You escape with Your life.'"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Josiah (*jo-ZY-ah*) — The reforming king of Judah who rediscovered the Book of the Law — tore down idols and restored temple worship; his name means 'the LORD heals' or 'supported by the LORD.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 36:1

v4 — Jer 1:10; Jer 31:28; Jer 18:7-10

v5 — Jer 39:18; Heb 13:5; 1 Tim 6:6-9; Matt 6:25-32; Jer 21:9

Chapter 46

The LORD pronounced judgment against Egypt and its army, which Nebuchadnezzar defeated at Carchemish by the Euphrates. Egypt's mighty men would flee and fall, and the LORD declared that Nebuchadnezzar would come and strike the land of Egypt. But the LORD promised Jacob not to fear, for He would save them from afar and discipline them in measure, though He would make a full end of the nations.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD which came to Jeremiah the prophet against the Gentiles;</i> | This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning the nations: |
| 2 | <i>Against Egypt, against the army of Pharaohnecho king of Egypt, which was by the river Euphrates in Carchemish, which Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon smote in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah:</i> | Concerning Egypt: This is the message against the army of Pharaoh Necho king of Egypt, which was defeated at Carchemish on the Euphrates River by Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon in the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah king of Judah: |
| 3 | <i>Order ye the buckler and shield, and draw near to battle.</i> | "Prepare your shields, both large and small, and march out for battle! |
| 4 | <i>Harness the horses; and get up, ye horsemen, and stand forth with your helmets; furbish the spears, and put on the brigandines.</i> | Harness the horses. Mount the steeds! Take your positions with helmets on! Polish your spears. Put on your armor! |
| 5 | <i>Wherefore have I seen them dismayed and turned away back? and their mighty ones are beaten down, and are fled apace, and look not back: for fear was round about, saith the LORD.</i> | What do I see? They are terrified. They are retreating. Their warriors are defeated. They flee in haste without looking back — and there is terror on every side," says the LORD. |
| 6 | <i>Let not the swift flee away, nor the mighty man escape; they shall stumble, and fall toward the north by the river Euphrates.</i> | "The swift cannot flee nor the strong escape. In the north by the River Euphrates they stumble and fall. |

- 7 *Who is this that cometh up as a flood, whose waters are moved as the rivers?* Who is this that rises like the Nile, like rivers of surging waters?
- 8 *Egypt riseth up like a flood, and his waters are moved like the rivers; and he saith, I will go up, and will cover the earth; I will destroy the city and the inhabitants thereof.* Egypt rises like the Nile, like rivers of surging waters. She says, 'I will rise and cover the earth. I will destroy cities and their people.'
- 9 *Come up, ye horses; and rage, ye chariots; and let the mighty men come forth; the Ethiopians and the Libyans, that handle the shield; and the Lydians, that handle and bend the bow.* Come up, You horses! Rage, You chariots! Let the mighty men come forth — the Ethiopians and the Libyans who handle the shield, and the Lydians who handle and bend the bow.
- 10 *For this is the day of the Lord GOD of hosts, a day of vengeance, that he may avenge him of his adversaries: and the sword shall devour, and it shall be satiate and made drunk with their blood: for the Lord GOD of hosts hath a sacrifice in the north country by the river Euphrates.* But that day belongs to the Lord GOD of hosts — a day of vengeance, for vengeance on His foes. The sword will devour till it is satisfied, till it has quenched its thirst with blood. For the Lord GOD of hosts will offer sacrifice in the land of the north by the River Euphrates.
- 11 *Go up into Gilead, and take balm, O virgin, the daughter of Egypt: in vain shalt thou use many medicines; for thou shalt not be cured.* "Go up to Gilead and get balm, Virgin Daughter Egypt. But You multiply remedies in vain. There is no healing for You.
- 12 *The nations have heard of thy shame, and thy cry hath filled the land: for the mighty man hath stumbled against the mighty, and they are fallen both together.* The nations will hear of your shame. Your cries will fill the earth. One warrior will stumble over another. Both will fall down together."

- 13 *The word that the LORD spake to Jeremiah the prophet, how Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon should come and smite the land of Egypt.* This is the message the LORD spoke to Jeremiah the prophet about the coming of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to attack Egypt:
- 14 *Declare ye in Egypt, and publish in Migdol, and publish in Noph and in Tahpanhes: say ye, Stand fast, and prepare thee; for the sword shall devour round about thee.* "Announce this in Egypt, and proclaim it in Migdol. Proclaim it also in Memphis and Tahpanhes: 'Take Your positions and prepare yourselves, for the sword devours those around You.'
- 15 *Why are thy valiant men swept away? they stood not, because the LORD did drive them.* Why will Your warriors be laid low? They cannot stand, for the LORD will push them down.
- 16 *He made many to fall, yea, one fell upon another: and they said, Arise, and let us go again to our own people, and to the land of our nativity, from the oppressing sword.* They will stumble repeatedly. They will fall over each other. They will say, 'Get up, let us go back to our own people and our native lands, away from the sword of the oppressor.'
- 17 *There did they cry, Pharaoh king of Egypt is but a noise; he hath passed the time appointed.* There they will cry out, 'Pharaoh king of Egypt is only a loud noise. He has missed his opportunity.'
- 18 *As I live, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts, Surely as Tabor is among the mountains, and as Carmel by the sea, so shall he come.* 'As surely as I live,' says the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts, 'one will come who is like Tabor among the mountains, like Carmel by the sea.
- 19 *O thou daughter dwelling in Egypt, furnish thyself to go into captivity: for Noph shall be waste and desolate without an inhabitant.* Pack Your belongings for exile, You who live in Egypt, for Memphis will be laid waste and lie in ruins without anyone living there.'
- 20 *Egypt is like a very fair heifer, but destruction cometh; it cometh out of the north.* Egypt is a beautiful heifer, but a gadfly is coming against her from the north.

- 21 *Also her hired men are in the midst of her like fatted bullocks; for they also are turned back, and are fled away together: they did not stand, because the day of their calamity was come upon them, and the time of their visitation.* The mercenaries in her ranks are like fattened calves. They too will turn and flee together. They will not stand their ground, for the day of disaster is coming on them — the time for them to be punished.
- 22 *The voice thereof shall go like a serpent; for they shall march with an army, and come against her with axes, as hewers of wood.* Egypt will hiss like a fleeing serpent as the enemy advances in force. They will come against her with axes, like men who cut down trees.
- 23 *They shall cut down her forest, saith the LORD, though it cannot be searched; because they are more than the grasshoppers, and are innumerable.* They will chop down her forest,' says the LORD, 'dense though it be. They are more numerous than locusts, they cannot be counted.
- 24 *The daughter of Egypt shall be confounded; she shall be delivered into the hand of the people of the north.* Daughter Egypt will be put to shame. She will be delivered into the hands of the people of the north."
- 25 *The LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saith; Behold, I will punish the multitude of No, and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with their gods, and their kings; even Pharaoh, and all them that trust in him:* The LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "I am about to punish Amon god of Thebes, Pharaoh, Egypt, and its gods and kings, and those who rely on Pharaoh.
- 26 *And I will deliver them into the hand of those that seek their lives, and into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of his servants: and afterward it shall be inhabited, as in the days of old, saith the LORD.* I will give them into the hands of those who seek their lives — Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and his officers. Afterward, however, Egypt will be inhabited as in times past," says the LORD.

- 27 *But fear not thou, O my servant Jacob, and be not dismayed, O Israel: for, behold, I will save thee from afar off, and thy seed from the land of their captivity; and Jacob shall return, and be in rest and at ease, and none shall make him afraid.* "Do not be afraid, Jacob My servant. Do not be dismayed, Israel. I will surely save you from a distant place. I will bring your descendants back from the land of their exile. Jacob will again have peace and security. No one will make them afraid.
- 28 *Fear not thou, O Jacob my servant, saith the LORD: for I am with thee; for I will make a full end of all the nations whither I have driven thee: but I will not make a full end of thee, but correct thee in measure; yet will I not leave thee wholly unpunished.* Do not be afraid, Jacob My servant," says the LORD, "for I am with You. Though I completely destroy all the nations among which I scatter you, I will not completely destroy You. I will discipline You but only in due measure. I will not let You go entirely unpunished."

Words in this chapter:

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Kgs 23:29
- v6 — Dan 11:19
- v7 — Jer 47:2
- v9 — Ezek 27:10; Isa 66:19
- v10 — Deut 32:42
- v11 — Jer 8:22
- v18 — Jer 48:15
- v19 — Isa 20:4
- v23 — Judg 7:12
- v26 — Ezek 32:11; Jer 44:30
- v27 — Isa 43:5; Jer 30:10-11; Isa 43:1; Isa 41:13-14; Jer 29:14
- v28 — Jer 10:24; 1 Cor 11:32; Rev 3:19

Chapter 47

The LORD pronounced judgment against the Philistines. Waters would rise out of the north as a flood and overflow the land. Fathers would not turn back for their children because of feebleness of hands. The LORD's sword would devour Ashkelon and the remnant of the coast, and there would be no rest for it.

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| <p>1 <i>The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet against the Philistines, before that Pharaoh smote Gaza.</i></p> | <p>This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning the Philistines before Pharaoh attacked Gaza:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thus saith the LORD; Behold, waters rise up out of the north, and shall be an overflowing flood, and shall overflow the land, and all that is therein; the city, and them that dwell therein: then the men shall cry, and all the inhabitants of the land shall howl.</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD says: Waters are rising in the north. They will become an overflowing torrent. They will overflow the land and everything in it, the towns and those who live in them. People will cry out and all who live in the land will wail</p> |
| <p>3 <i>At the noise of the stamping of the hoofs of his strong horses, at the rushing of his chariots, and at the rumbling of his wheels, the fathers shall not look back to their children for feebleness of hands;</i></p> | <p>at the sound of the hooves of galloping stallions, at the noise of enemy chariots and the rumble of their wheels. Fathers will not turn back for their children. Their hands will hang limp</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Because of the day that cometh to spoil all the Philistines, and to cut off from Tyrus and Zidon every helper that remaineth: for the LORD will spoil the Philistines, the remnant of the country of Caphtor.</i></p> | <p>because the day has come to destroy all the Philistines and to cut off all survivors who could help Tyre and Sidon. The LORD is about to destroy the Philistines, the remnant from the coasts of Caphtor.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Baldness is come upon Gaza; Ashkelon is cut off with the remnant of their valley: how long wilt thou cut thyself?</i></p> | <p>Gaza will shave her head in mourning. Ashkelon will be silenced. You remnant on the plain, how long will You cut yourselves?</p> |
| <p>6 <i>O thou sword of the LORD, how long will it be ere thou be quiet? put up thyself into thy scabbard, rest, and be still.</i></p> | <p>"Ah, sword of the LORD, how long before You rest? Return to Your scabbard. Cease and be still.</p> |

- 7 *How can it be quiet, seeing the LORD hath given it a charge against Ashkelon, and against the sea shore? there hath he appointed it.* But how can it rest when the LORD has commanded it to attack Ashkelon and the seacoast?"

Words in this chapter:

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast; gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 25:20
 v4 — Amos 9:7
 v5 — Jer 48:37; Jer 25:20
 v6 — Jer 12:12; Ezek 21:3-5

Chapter 48

The LORD pronounced an extensive judgment against Moab. Every city would be destroyed, and Moab's horn was cut off. Moab had been at ease from his youth and trusted in his works and treasures, but Chemosh his god would go into captivity. The LORD declared woe upon Moab for the destroyer had come upon every city, yet He would bring back the captives of Moab in the latter days.

- 1 *Against Moab thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Woe unto Nebo! for it is spoiled; Kiriathaim is confounded and taken: Misgab is confounded and dismayed.* Concerning Moab: This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Woe to Nebo, for it will be ruined. Kiriathaim will be disgraced and captured. The stronghold will be disgraced and shattered.
- 2 *There shall be no more praise of Moab: in Heshbon they have devised evil against it; come, and let us cut it off from being a nation. Also thou shalt be brought to silence, O Madmen; the sword shall pursue thee.* Moab will be praised no more. In Heshbon people will plot her downfall: 'Come, let us put an end to that nation.' You too, Madmen, will be silenced. The sword will pursue You.
- 3 *A voice of crying shall be from Horonaim, spoiling and great destruction.* Listen to the cries from Horonaim — cries of great havoc and destruction.

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| 4 | <i>Moab is destroyed; her little ones have caused a cry to be heard.</i> | Moab will be broken. Her little ones will cry out. |
| 5 | <i>For in the going up of Luhith continual weeping shall go up; for in the going down of Horonaim the enemies have heard a cry of destruction.</i> | They go up the hill of Luhith, weeping bitterly as they go. On the road down to Horonaim anguished cries over the destruction are heard. |
| 6 | <i>Flee, save your lives, and be like the heath in the wilderness.</i> | Flee! Run for Your lives! Become like a bush in the desert. |
| 7 | <i>For because thou hast trusted in thy works and in thy treasures, thou shalt also be taken: and Chemosh shall go forth into captivity with his priests and his princes together.</i> | Since You trust in Your deeds and riches, You too will be taken captive. Chemosh will go into exile, together with His priests and officials. |
| 8 | <i>And the spoiler shall come upon every city, and no city shall escape: the valley also shall perish, and the plain shall be destroyed, as the LORD hath spoken.</i> | The destroyer will come against every town. Not one town will escape. The valley will be ruined and the plateau destroyed, because the LORD has spoken. |
| 9 | <i>Give wings unto Moab, that it may flee and get away: for the cities thereof shall be desolate, without any to dwell therein.</i> | Put salt on Moab, for she will be laid waste. Her towns will become desolate, with no one to live in them. |
| 10 | <i>Cursed be he that doeth the work of the LORD deceitfully, and cursed be he that keepeth back his sword from blood.</i> | Cursed is the one who is lax in doing the LORD's work! Cursed is the one who keeps his sword from bloodshed! |
| 11 | <i>Moab hath been at ease from his youth, and he hath settled on his lees, and hath not been emptied from vessel to vessel, neither hath he gone into captivity: therefore his taste remained in him, and his scent is not changed.</i> | "Moab has been at ease from her youth, settled like wine on its dregs, never poured from one jar to another — she has never gone into exile. So she tastes as she did, and her aroma is unchanged. |

- 12 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will send unto him wanderers, that shall cause him to wander, and shall empty his vessels, and break their bottles.* But days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will send men who pour from jars, and they will pour her out. They will empty her jars and smash her jugs.
- 13 *And Moab shall be ashamed of Chemosh, as the house of Israel was ashamed of Bethel their confidence.* Then Moab will be ashamed of Chemosh, as Israel was ashamed of Bethel, in which they trusted.
- 14 *How say ye, We are mighty and strong men for the war?* How can You say, 'We are warriors, men valiant in battle'?
- 15 *Moab is spoiled, and gone up out of her cities, and his chosen young men are gone down to the slaughter, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.* Moab will be destroyed and her towns invaded. Her finest young men will go down in the slaughter," says the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.
- 16 *The calamity of Moab is near to come, and his affliction hasteth fast.* "The fall of Moab is at hand. Her calamity will come quickly.
- 17 *All ye that are about him, bemoan him; and all ye that know his name, say, How is the strong staff broken, and the beautiful rod!* Mourn for her, all who live around her, all who know her fame. Say, 'How the mighty scepter is broken, that glorious staff!'
- 18 *Thou daughter that dost inhabit Dibon, come down from thy glory, and sit in thirst; for the spoiler of Moab shall come upon thee, and he shall destroy thy strong holds.* Come down from Your glory and sit on the parched ground, You inhabitants of Daughter Dibon. For the one who destroys Moab will come up against you and ruin Your fortified cities.
- 19 *O inhabitant of Aroer, stand by the way, and espy; ask him that fleeth, and her that escapeth, and say, What is done?* Stand by the road and watch, you who live in Aroer. Ask the man fleeing and the woman escaping, ask them, 'What has happened?'
- 20 *Moab is confounded; for it is broken down: howl and cry; tell ye it in Arnon, that Moab is spoiled,* Moab is disgraced, for she is shattered. Wail and cry out! Announce by the Arnon that Moab is destroyed.

- 21 *And judgment is come upon the plain country; upon Holon, and upon Jahazah, and upon Mephaath,* Judgment has come to the plateau — to Holon, Jahzah, and Mephaath,
- 22 *And upon Dibon, and upon Nebo, and upon Bethdiblathaim,* to Dibon, Nebo, and Beth Diblathaim,
- 23 *And upon Kiriathaim, and upon Bethgamul, and upon Bethmeon,* to Kiriathaim, Beth Gamul, and Beth Meon,
- 24 *And upon Kerioth, and upon Bozrah, and upon all the cities of the land of Moab, far or near.* to Kerioth and Bozrah — to all the towns of Moab, far and near.
- 25 *The horn of Moab is cut off, and his arm is broken, saith the LORD.* Moab's horn is cut off. Her arm is broken," says the LORD.
- 26 *Make ye him drunken: for he magnified himself against the LORD: Moab also shall wallow in his vomit, and he also shall be in derision.* "Make her drunk, for she has defied the LORD. Let Moab wallow in her vomit. Let her be an object of ridicule.
- 27 *For was not Israel a derision unto thee? was he found among thieves? for since thou spakest of him, thou skippedst for joy.* Was not Israel the object of Your ridicule? Was she caught among thieves, that You shake Your head in scorn whenever You speak of her?
- 28 *O ye that dwell in Moab, leave the cities, and dwell in the rock, and be like the dove that maketh her nest in the sides of the hole's mouth.* Abandon Your towns and dwell among the rocks, You who live in Moab. Be like a dove that makes its nest at the mouth of a cave.
- 29 *We have heard the pride of Moab, (he is exceeding proud) his loftiness, and his arrogancy, and his pride, and the haughtiness of his heart.* We have heard of Moab's pride — her great pride — of her arrogance, her conceit, and the haughtiness of her heart.
- 30 *I know his wrath, saith the LORD; but it shall not be so; his lies shall not so effect it.* I know her insolence," says the LORD, "but her boasts are empty — her deeds amount to nothing.
- 31 *Therefore will I howl for Moab, and I will cry out for all Moab; mine heart shall mourn for the men of Kirheres.* Therefore I wail over Moab, for all Moab I cry out. I moan for the people of Kir Hareseth.

- 32 *O vine of Sibmah, I will weep for thee with the weeping of Jazer: thy plants are gone over the sea, they reach even to the sea of Jazer: the spoiler is fallen upon thy summer fruits and upon thy vintage.* I weep for You, vine of Sibmah, more than I weep for Jazer. Your branches spread as far as the sea. They reached as far as Jazer. The destroyer has fallen on Your summer fruit and Your grape harvest.
- 33 *And joy and gladness is taken from the plentiful field, and from the land of Moab; and I have caused wine to fail from the winepresses: none shall tread with shouting; their shouting shall be no shouting.* Joy and gladness are gone from the orchards and fields of Moab. I have stopped the flow of wine from the presses. No one treads grapes with shouts of joy. Although there are shouts, they are not shouts of joy.
- 34 *From the cry of Heshbon even unto Elealeh, and even unto Jahaz, have they uttered their voice, from Zoar even unto Horonaim, as an heifer of three years old: for the waters also of Nimrim shall be desolate.* The sound of their cry rises from Heshbon to Elealeh and Jahaz — from Zoar as far as Horonaim and Eglath Shelishiyah. Even the waters of Nimrim are dried up.
- 35 *Moreover I will cause to cease in Moab, saith the LORD, him that offereth in the high places, and him that burneth incense to his gods.* In Moab I will put an end to those who make offerings on the high places and burn incense to their gods," says the LORD.
- 36 *Therefore mine heart shall sound for Moab like pipes, and mine heart shall sound like pipes for the men of Kirheres: because the riches that he hath gotten are perished.* "So My heart laments for Moab like the music of a pipe. My heart laments like a pipe for the people of Kir Hareseth. The wealth they acquired is gone.
- 37 *For every head shall be bald, and every beard clipped: upon all the hands shall be cuttings, and upon the loins sackcloth.* Every head is shaved and every beard cut off. Every hand is slashed and every waist is covered with sackcloth.

- 38 *There shall be lamentation generally upon all the housetops of Moab, and in the streets thereof: for I have broken Moab like a vessel wherein is no pleasure, saith the LORD.* On all the rooftops in Moab and in the public squares there is nothing but mourning. For I have broken Moab like a jar that no one wants," says the LORD.
- 39 *They shall howl, saying, How is it broken down! how hath Moab turned the back with shame! so shall Moab be a derision and a dismay to all them about him.* "How shattered she is! How they wail! How Moab turns her back in shame! Moab has become an object of ridicule, an object of horror to all those around her."
- 40 *For thus saith the LORD; Behold, he shall fly as an eagle, and shall spread his wings over Moab.* This is what the LORD says: "Look! An eagle is swooping down, spreading its wings over Moab.
- 41 *Kerioth is taken, and the strong holds are surprised, and the mighty men's hearts in Moab at that day shall be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.* Kerioth will be captured and the strongholds taken. In that day the hearts of Moab's warriors will be like the heart of a woman in labor.
- 42 *And Moab shall be destroyed from being a people, because he hath magnified himself against the LORD.* Moab will be destroyed as a nation because she defied the LORD.
- 43 *Fear, and the pit, and the snare, shall be upon thee, O inhabitant of Moab, saith the LORD.* Terror and pit and snare await You, people of Moab," says the LORD.
- 44 *He that fleeth from the fear shall fall into the pit; and he that getteth up out of the pit shall be taken in the snare: for I will bring upon it, even upon Moab, the year of their visitation, saith the LORD.* Whoever flees from the terror will fall into a pit. Whoever climbs out of the pit will be caught in a snare. For I will bring on Moab the year of her punishment," says the LORD.

- 45 *They that fled stood under the shadow of Heshbon because of the force: but a fire shall come forth out of Heshbon, and a flame from the midst of Sihon, and shall devour the corner of Moab, and the crown of the head of the tumultuous ones.* In the shadow of Heshbon the fugitives stand helpless, for a fire has gone out from Heshbon — a blaze from the midst of Sihon. It burns the foreheads of Moab, the skulls of the noisy boasters.
- 46 *Woe be unto thee, O Moab! the people of Chemosh perisheth: for thy sons are taken captives, and thy daughters captives.* Woe to You, Moab! The people of Chemosh are destroyed. Your sons are taken into exile and Your daughters into captivity.
- 47 *Yet will I bring again the captivity of Moab in the latter days, saith the LORD. Thus far is the judgment of Moab.* Yet I will restore the fortunes of Moab in days to come," says the LORD. Here ends the judgment on Moab.

Words in this chapter:

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Isa 15:5
v7 — Num 21:29
v10 — 1 Sam 15:3; 1 Kgs 20:42; Judg 5:23; 1 Sam 15:9; 2 Kgs 13:19
v11 — Zeph 1:12; Zech 1:15; Jer 48:29
v15 — Jer 50:27; Jer 46:18
v18 — Num 21:30; Isa 47:1
v19 — Deut 2:36
v21 — Josh 13:18
v23 — Josh 13:17
v31 — 2 Kgs 3:25; Isa 15:5
v35 — Isa 15:2; Isa 16:12
v47 — Jer 49:6; Jer 49:39

Chapter 49

The LORD pronounced judgment against Ammon for seizing the territory of Gad, against Edom for her pride in the clefts of the rock, against Damascus whose young men would fall in her streets, against Kedar and Hazor whom Nebuchadnezzar would strike, and against Elam

whose bow the LORD would break. Yet the LORD would restore the fortunes of Ammon and Elam in the latter days.

- 1 *Concerning the Ammonites, thus saith the LORD; Hath Israel no sons? hath he no heir? why then doth their king inherit Gad, and his people dwell in his cities?*

Concerning the Ammonites: Thus says the LORD: "Has Israel no sons? Has He no heir? Why then does their king inherit Gad, and His people dwell in His cities?
- 2 *Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will cause an alarm of war to be heard in Rabbah of the Ammonites; and it shall be a desolate heap, and her daughters shall be burned with fire: then shall Israel be heir unto them that were his heirs, saith the LORD.*

But the days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will sound the battle cry against Rabbah of the Ammonites. It will become a mound of ruins, and its surrounding villages will be set on fire. Then Israel will drive out those who drove her out," says the LORD.
- 3 *Howl, O Heshbon, for Ai is spoiled: cry, ye daughters of Rabbah, gird you with sackcloth; lament, and run to and fro by the hedges; for their king shall go into captivity, and his priests and his princes together.*

Wail, O Heshbon, for Ai is spoiled! Cry, daughters of Rabbah! Put on sackcloth and lament. Run to and fro by the hedges, for their king shall go into captivity, and His priests and His princes together.
- 4 *Wherefore gloriest thou in the valleys, thy flowing valley, O backsliding daughter? that trusted in her treasures, saying, Who shall come unto me?*

Why do You boast of Your valleys, boast of Your flowing valleys, unfaithful daughter? You trust in Your riches and say, 'Who will attack me?'
- 5 *Behold, I will bring a fear upon thee, saith the Lord GOD of hosts, from all those that be about thee; and ye shall be driven out every man right forth; and none shall gather up him that wandereth.*

I will bring terror on You from all those around You," says the Lord GOD of hosts. "Every one of you will be driven away, and no one will gather the fugitives.
- 6 *And afterward I will bring again the captivity of the children of Ammon, saith the LORD.*

Yet afterward, I will restore the fortunes of the Ammonites," says the LORD.

- 7 *Concerning Edom, thus saith the LORD of hosts; Is wisdom no more in Teman? is counsel perished from the prudent? is their wisdom vanished?* Concerning Edom: This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Is there no longer wisdom in Teman? Has counsel perished from the prudent? Has their wisdom decayed?"
- 8 *Flee ye, turn back, dwell deep, O inhabitants of Dedan; for I will bring the calamity of Esau upon him, the time that I will visit him.* Turn and flee! Hide in deep caves, you who live in Dedan! For I will bring disaster on Esau at the time I punish him.
- 9 *If grapegatherers come to thee, would they not leave some gleaning grapes? if thieves by night, they will destroy till they have enough.* If grape pickers came to you, would they not leave a few grapes? If thieves came during the night, would they not steal only as much as they wanted?
- 10 *But I have made Esau bare, I have uncovered his secret places, and he shall not be able to hide himself: his seed is spoiled, and his brethren, and his neighbours, and he is not.* But I will strip Esau bare. I will uncover his hiding places so that he cannot conceal himself. His children, relatives, and neighbors will perish, and he will be no more.
- 11 *Leave thy fatherless children, I will preserve them alive; and let thy widows trust in me.* Leave your fatherless children. I will keep them alive. Your widows too can trust in Me."
- 12 *For thus saith the LORD; Behold, they whose judgment was not to drink of the cup have assuredly drunken it; and art thou he that shall altogether go unpunished? thou shalt not go unpunished, but thou shalt surely drink of it.* This is what the LORD says: "If those who do not deserve to drink the cup must drink it, why should You go unpunished? You will not go unpunished, but must drink it.
- 13 *For I have sworn by myself, saith the LORD, that Bozrah shall become a desolation, a reproach, a waste, and a curse; and all the cities thereof shall be perpetual wastes.* I swear by Myself," says the LORD, "that Bozrah will become a ruin and a curse, an object of horror and disgrace. And all its towns will be in ruins forever."

- 14 *I have heard a rumour from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent unto the nations, saying, Gather yourselves together, and come against her, and rise up to the battle.* I have heard a message from the LORD. An envoy was sent to the nations to say, "Assemble yourselves to attack it! Rise up for battle!"
- 15 *For, lo, I will make thee small among the heathen, and despised among men.* "Now I will make You small among the nations, despised by mankind.
- 16 *Thy terribleness hath deceived thee, and the pride of thine heart, O thou that dwellest in the clefts of the rock, that holdest the height of the hill: though thou shouldest make thy nest as high as the eagle, I will bring thee down from thence, saith the LORD.* The terror You inspire and the pride of Your heart have deceived You, You who live in the clefts of the rocks, who occupy the heights of the hill. Though You build Your nest as high as the eagle's, from there I will bring You down," says the LORD.
- 17 *Also Edom shall be a desolation: every one that goeth by it shall be astonished, and shall hiss at all the plagues thereof.* "Edom will become an object of horror. All who pass by will be appalled and will scoff because of all its wounds.
- 18 *As in the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighbour cities thereof, saith the LORD, no man shall abide there, neither shall a son of man dwell in it.* As Sodom and Gomorrah were overthrown, along with their neighboring towns," says the LORD, "so no one will live there. No person will dwell in it.
- 19 *Behold, he shall come up like a lion from the swelling of Jordan against the habitation of the strong: but I will suddenly make him run away from her: and who is a chosen man, that I may appoint over her? for who is like me? and who will appoint me the time? and who is that shepherd that will stand before me?* Like a lion coming up from Jordan's thickets to a rich pastureland, I will chase Edom from its land in an instant. Who is the chosen one I will appoint for this? Who is like Me and who can challenge Me? And what shepherd can stand against Me?"

- 20 *Therefore hear the counsel of the LORD, that he hath taken against Edom; and his purposes, that he hath purposed against the inhabitants of Teman: Surely the least of the flock shall draw them out: surely he shall make their habitations desolate with them.* Therefore, hear what the LORD has planned against Edom, what He has purposed against those who live in Teman: The young of the flock will be dragged away. He will completely destroy their pasture because of them.
- 21 *The earth is moved at the noise of their fall, at the cry the noise thereof was heard in the Red sea.* At the sound of their fall the earth will tremble. Their cry will resound to the Red Sea.
- 22 *Behold, he shall come up and fly as the eagle, and spread his wings over Bozrah: and at that day shall the heart of the mighty men of Edom be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.* Look! An eagle will soar and swoop down, spreading its wings over Bozrah. In that day the hearts of Edom's warriors will be like the heart of a woman in labor.
- 23 *Concerning Damascus. Hamath is confounded, and Arpad: for they have heard evil tidings: they are fainthearted; there is sorrow on the sea; it cannot be quiet.* Concerning Damascus: "Hamath and Arpad are dismayed, for they have heard bad news. They are disheartened. There is anguish and sorrow, like the churning sea that cannot rest.
- 24 *Damascus is waxed feeble, and turneth herself to flee, and fear hath seized on her: anguish and sorrows have taken her, as a woman in travail.* Damascus has become feeble. She has turned to flee and panic has gripped her. Anguish and pain have seized her, pain like that of a woman in labor.
- 25 *How is the city of praise not left, the city of my joy!* Why has the city of renown not been abandoned, the town in which I delight?
- 26 *Therefore her young men shall fall in her streets, and all the men of war shall be cut off in that day, saith the LORD of hosts.* Surely, her young men will fall in the streets. All her soldiers will be silenced in that day," says the LORD of hosts.
- 27 *And I will kindle a fire in the wall of Damascus, and it shall consume the palaces of Benhadad.* "I will set fire to the walls of Damascus. It will consume the fortresses of Ben-Hadad."

- 28 *Concerning Kedar, and concerning the kingdoms of Hazor, which Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon shall smite, thus saith the LORD; Arise ye, go up to Kedar, and spoil the men of the east.* Concerning Kedar and the kingdoms of Hazor, which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon attacked: This is what the LORD says: "Rise up! Advance against Kedar! Destroy the people of the East!
- 29 *Their tents and their flocks shall be taken away: they shall take to themselves their curtains, and all their vessels, and their camels; and they shall cry unto them, Fear is on every side.* Their tents and their flocks will be taken. Their shelters will be carried off with all their goods and camels. People will shout to them, "Terror on every side!"
- 30 *Flee, get you far off, dwell deep, O ye inhabitants of Hazor, saith the LORD; for Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon hath taken counsel against you, and hath conceived a purpose against you.* Flee quickly! Stay in deep caves, You who live in Hazor," says the LORD. "For Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has plotted against You and formed a plan to destroy You.
- 31 *Arise, get you up unto the wealthy nation, that dwelleth without care, saith the LORD, which have neither gates nor bars, which dwell alone.* Rise up! Attack a nation at ease, that lives in confidence," says the LORD, "a nation that has neither gates nor bars. Its people live alone.
- 32 *And their camels shall be for a booty, and the multitude of their cattle for a spoil: and I will scatter into all winds them that are in the utmost corners; and I will bring their calamity from all sides thereof, saith the LORD.* Their camels will become plunder, and their large herds will be spoils of war. I will scatter to the winds those who are in distant places and will bring disaster on them from every side," says the LORD.
- 33 *And Hazor shall be a dwelling for dragons, and a desolation for ever: there shall no man abide there, nor any son of man dwell in it.* Hazor will become a haunt of jackals, a desolate place forever. No one will live there. No people will settle in it."
- 34 *The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet against Elam in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, saying,* This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning Elam, early in the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah:

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| <p>35 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will break the bow of Elam, the chief of their might.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And upon Elam will I bring the four winds from the four quarters of heaven, and will scatter them toward all those winds; and there shall be no nation whither the outcasts of Elam shall not come.</i></p> <p>37 <i>For I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies, and before them that seek their life: and I will bring evil upon them, even my fierce anger, saith the LORD; and I will send the sword after them, till I have consumed them:</i></p> <p>38 <i>And I will set my throne in Elam, and will destroy from thence the king and the princes, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>39 <i>But it shall come to pass in the latter days, that I will bring again the captivity of Elam, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts says: 'See, I will break the bow of Elam, the mainstay of their might.</p> <p>I will bring against Elam the four winds from the four quarters of the heavens. I will scatter them to all these winds, and there will not be a nation where Elam's exiles do not go.</p> <p>I will shatter Elam before their foes, before those who seek their lives. I will bring disaster on them, even My fierce anger,' says the LORD. 'I will pursue them with the sword until I have made an end of them.</p> <p>I will set My throne in Elam and destroy her king and officials,' says the LORD.</p> <p>'Yet in days to come I will restore the fortunes of Elam,' says the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Jer 4:19

v3 — Jer 48:7

v4 — 1 Tim 6:17

v6 — Jer 49:39; Jer 48:47

v7 — Amos 1:11-12

v11 — Ps 68:5; Hos 14:3; Jas 1:27

v17 — Ezek 35:7; Jer 50:13

v18 — Jer 49:33; Deut 29:23

v19 — Jer 12:5

v20 — Jer 50:45

v23 — Isa 10:9; 2 Kgs 18:34

v34 — Gen 14:1; Jer 25:25; Dan 8:2; Gen 10:22

Chapter 50

The LORD pronounced judgment against Babylon and the land of the Chaldeans. Babylon would be taken, Bel put to shame, and Merodach broken in pieces. Israel and Judah would seek the LORD with weeping and ask the way to Zion. The LORD would raise up an assembly of great nations from the north against Babylon, and she would become a desolation -- as she did to others, so it would be done to her.

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| <p>1 <i>The word that the LORD spake against Babylon and against the land of the Chaldeans by Jeremiah the prophet.</i></p> | <p>This is the word the LORD spoke through Jeremiah the prophet concerning Babylon and the land of the Babylonians:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Declare ye among the nations, and publish, and set up a standard; publish, and conceal not: say, Babylon is taken, Bel is confounded, Merodach is broken in pieces; her idols are confounded, her images are broken in pieces.</i></p> | <p>"Announce and proclaim among the nations. Lift up a banner and proclaim it. Keep nothing back but say, 'Babylon will be captured. Bel will be put to shame. Marduk filled with terror. Her images will be put to shame and her idols filled with terror.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For out of the north there cometh up a nation against her, which shall make her land desolate, and none shall dwell therein: they shall remove, they shall depart, both man and beast.</i></p> | <p>A nation from the north will attack her and lay waste her land. No one will live in it. Both people and animals will flee away.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>In those days, and in that time, saith the LORD, the children of Israel shall come, they and the children of Judah together, going and weeping: they shall go, and seek the LORD their God.</i></p> | <p>"In those days, at that time," says the LORD, "the people of Israel and the people of Judah together will go in tears to seek the LORD their God.</p> |

- 5 *They shall ask the way to Zion with their faces thitherward, saying, Come, and let us join ourselves to the LORD in a perpetual covenant that shall not be forgotten.* They will ask the way to Zion and turn their faces toward it. They will come and bind themselves to the LORD in an everlasting covenant that will not be forgotten.
- 6 *My people hath been lost sheep: their shepherds have caused them to go astray, they have turned them away on the mountains: they have gone from mountain to hill, they have forgotten their restingplace.* "My people have been lost sheep. Their shepherds have led them astray. They have wandered over mountain and hill and forgotten their resting place.
- 7 *All that found them have devoured them: and their adversaries said, We offend not, because they have sinned against the LORD, the habitation of justice, even the LORD, the hope of their fathers.* Whoever found them devoured them. Their enemies said, 'We are not guilty, for they sinned against the LORD, their true pasture, the LORD, the hope of their ancestors.'
- 8 *Remove out of the midst of Babylon, and go forth out of the land of the Chaldeans, and be as the he goats before the flocks.* Flee out of Babylon! Leave the land of the Babylonians and be like the goats that lead the flock.
- 9 *For, lo, I will raise and cause to come up against Babylon an assembly of great nations from the north country: and they shall set themselves in array against her; from thence she shall be taken: their arrows shall be as of a mighty expert man; none shall return in vain.* For I will stir up and bring against Babylon an alliance of great nations from the land of the north. They will take up their positions against her, and from the north she will be captured. Their arrows will be like skilled warriors who do not return empty-handed.
- 10 *And Chaldea shall be a spoil: all that spoil her shall be satisfied, saith the LORD.* So Babylonia will be plundered. All who plunder her will have their fill," says the LORD.

- 11 *Because ye were glad, because ye rejoiced, O ye destroyers of mine heritage, because ye are grown fat as the heifer at grass, and bellow as bulls;* "Because You rejoice and are glad, You who pillage My inheritance — because You frolic like a heifer threshing grain and neigh like stallions —
- 12 *Your mother shall be sore confounded; she that bare you shall be ashamed: behold, the hindermost of the nations shall be a wilderness, a dry land, and a desert.* your mother will be greatly ashamed. She who gave You birth will be disgraced. She will be the least of the nations — a wilderness, a dry land, a desert.
- 13 *Because of the wrath of the LORD it shall not be inhabited, but it shall be wholly desolate: every one that goeth by Babylon shall be astonished, and hiss at all her plagues.* Because of the LORD's anger she will not be inhabited but will be completely desolate. All who pass Babylon will be horrified and scoff because of all her wounds.
- 14 *Put yourselves in array against Babylon round about: all ye that bend the bow, shoot at her, spare no arrows: for she hath sinned against the LORD.* "Take up Your positions around Babylon, all You who draw the bow. Shoot at her! Spare no arrows, for she has sinned against the LORD.
- 15 *Shout against her round about: she hath given her hand: her foundations are fallen, her walls are thrown down: for it is the vengeance of the LORD: take vengeance upon her; as she hath done, do unto her.* Shout against her on every side! She surrenders. Her towers fall. Her walls are torn down. Since this is the vengeance of the LORD, take vengeance on her. Do to her as she has done to others.
- 16 *Cut off the sower from Babylon, and him that handleth the sickle in the time of harvest: for fear of the oppressing sword they shall turn every one to his people, and they shall flee every one to his own land.* Cut off from Babylon the sower, and the reaper with His sickle at harvest. Because of the oppressor's sword, each will return to their own people. Each will flee to their own land.

- 17 *Israel is a scattered sheep; the lions have driven him away: first the king of Assyria hath devoured him; and last this Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon hath broken his bones.* "Israel is a scattered flock that lions have chased away. The first to devour them was the king of Assyria. The last to crush their bones was Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon."
- 18 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will punish the king of Babylon and his land, as I have punished the king of Assyria.* Therefore this is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "I will punish the king of Babylon and his land as I punished the king of Assyria."
- 19 *And I will bring Israel again to his habitation, and he shall feed on Carmel and Bashan, and his soul shall be satisfied upon mount Ephraim and Gilead.* But I will bring Israel back to their own pasture, and they will graze on Carmel and Bashan. Their appetite will be satisfied on the hills of Ephraim and Gilead.
- 20 *In those days, and in that time, saith the LORD, the iniquity of Israel shall be sought for, and there shall be none; and the sins of Judah, and they shall not be found: for I will pardon them whom I reserve.* In those days, at that time," says the LORD, "search will be made for Israel's iniquity, but there will be none, and for the sins of Judah, but none will be found, for I will forgive the remnant I spare."
- 21 *Go up against the land of Merathaim, even against it, and against the inhabitants of Pekod: waste and utterly destroy after them, saith the LORD, and do according to all that I have commanded thee.* "Attack the land of Merathaim and those who live in Pekod. Pursue, kill, and completely destroy them," says the LORD. "Do everything I have commanded You."
- 22 *A sound of battle is in the land, and of great destruction.* The noise of battle is in the land — the noise of great destruction!
- 23 *How is the hammer of the whole earth cut asunder and broken! how is Babylon become a desolation among the nations!* How broken and shattered is the hammer of the whole earth! How desolate is Babylon among the nations!

- 24 *I have laid a snare for thee, and thou art also taken, O Babylon, and thou wast not aware: thou art found, and also caught, because thou hast striven against the LORD.* I set a trap for You, Babylon, and You were caught before You knew it. You were found and captured because You opposed the LORD.
- 25 *The LORD hath opened his armoury, and hath brought forth the weapons of his indignation: for this is the work of the Lord GOD of hosts in the land of the Chaldeans.* The LORD has opened His armory and brought out the weapons of His wrath, for the Sovereign LORD of hosts has work to do in the land of the Babylonians.
- 26 *Come against her from the utmost border, open her storehouses: cast her up as heaps, and destroy her utterly: let nothing of her be left.* Come against her from afar. Break open her granaries. Pile her up like heaps of grain. Completely destroy her and leave no remnant.
- 27 *Slay all her bullocks; let them go down to the slaughter: woe unto them! for their day is come, the time of their visitation.* Kill all her young bulls. Let them go down to the slaughter! Woe to them! For their day has come — the time of their punishment.
- 28 *The voice of them that flee and escape out of the land of Babylon, to declare in Zion the vengeance of the LORD our God, the vengeance of his temple.* Listen to the fugitives and refugees from Babylon declaring in Zion how the LORD our God has taken His revenge, revenge for His temple.
- 29 *Call together the archers against Babylon: all ye that bend the bow, camp against it round about; let none thereof escape: recompense her according to her work; according to all that she hath done, do unto her: for she hath been proud against the LORD, against the Holy One of Israel.* Summon archers against Babylon, all those who draw the bow. Encamp all around her. Let no one escape. Repay her for her deeds. Do to her as she has done. For she has defied the LORD, the Holy One of Israel.
- 30 *Therefore shall her young men fall in the streets, and all her men of war shall be cut off in that day, saith the LORD.* Therefore, her young men will fall in the streets. All her soldiers will be silenced in that day," says the LORD.

- 31 *Behold, I am against thee, O thou most proud, saith the Lord GOD of hosts: for thy day is come, the time that I will visit thee.* "See, I am against You, arrogant one," says the Lord GOD of hosts. "For Your day has come — the time for You to be punished.
- 32 *And the most proud shall stumble and fall, and none shall raise him up: and I will kindle a fire in his cities, and it shall devour all round about him.* The arrogant one will stumble and fall and no one will help her up. I will kindle a fire in her towns that will consume all who are around her."
- 33 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; The children of Israel and the children of Judah were oppressed together: and all that took them captives held them fast; they refused to let them go.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: "The people of Israel are oppressed, and the people of Judah as well. All their captors hold them fast, refusing to let them go.
- 34 *Their Redeemer is strong; the LORD of hosts is his name: he shall thoroughly plead their cause, that he may give rest to the land, and disquiet the inhabitants of Babylon.* Yet their Redeemer is strong. The LORD of hosts is His name. He will vigorously defend their cause so that He may bring rest to their land, but unrest to those who live in Babylon.
- 35 *A sword is upon the Chaldeans, saith the LORD, and upon the inhabitants of Babylon, and upon her princes, and upon her wise men.* "A sword against the Babylonians!" says the LORD — "against those who live in Babylon and against her officials and wise men!
- 36 *A sword is upon the liars; and they shall dote: a sword is upon her mighty men; and they shall be dismayed.* A sword against her false prophets! They will become fools. A sword against her warriors! They will be filled with terror.
- 37 *A sword is upon their horses, and upon their chariots, and upon all the mingled people that are in the midst of her; and they shall become as women: a sword is upon her treasures; and they shall be robbed.* A sword against her horses and chariots and all the foreigners in her ranks! They will become weaklings. A sword against her treasures! They will be plundered.

- 38 *A drought is upon her waters; and they shall be dried up: for it is the land of graven images, and they are mad upon their idols.* A drought on her waters! They will dry up. For it is a land of idols — idols that will go mad with terror.
- 39 *Therefore the wild beasts of the desert with the wild beasts of the islands shall dwell there, and the owls shall dwell therein: and it shall be no more inhabited for ever; neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation.* So desert creatures and hyenas will live there, and there the owl will dwell. It will never again be inhabited or lived in from generation to generation.
- 40 *As God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighbour cities thereof, saith the LORD; so shall no man abide there, neither shall any son of man dwell therein.* As I overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah along with their neighboring towns," says the LORD, "so no one will live there. No people will settle in it.
- 41 *Behold, a people shall come from the north, and a great nation, and many kings shall be raised up from the coasts of the earth.* Look! An army is coming from the north. A great nation and many kings are being stirred up from the ends of the earth.
- 42 *They shall hold the bow and the lance: they are cruel, and will not shew mercy: their voice shall roar like the sea, and they shall ride upon horses, every one put in array, like a man to the battle, against thee, O daughter of Babylon.* They are armed with bows and spears. They are cruel and without mercy. Their sound is like the roaring sea as they ride on their horses. They come in battle formation — arrayed as one man — against You, Daughter Babylon.
- 43 *The king of Babylon hath heard the report of them, and his hands waxed feeble: anguish took hold of him, and pangs as of a woman in travail.* The king of Babylon has heard reports about them, and his hands hang limp. Anguish has gripped him, pain like that of a woman in labor.

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| <p>44 <i>Behold, he shall come up like a lion from the swelling of Jordan unto the habitation of the strong: but I will make them suddenly run away from her: and who is a chosen man, that I may appoint over her? for who is like me? and who will appoint me the time? and who is that shepherd that will stand before me?</i></p> <p>45 <i>Therefore hear ye the counsel of the LORD, that he hath taken against Babylon; and his purposes, that he hath purposed against the land of the Chaldeans: Surely the least of the flock shall draw them out: surely he shall make their habitation desolate with them.</i></p> <p>46 <i>At the noise of the taking of Babylon the earth is moved, and the cry is heard among the nations.</i></p> | <p>Like a lion coming up from Jordan's thickets to a rich pastureland, I will chase Babylon from its land in an instant. Who is the chosen one I will appoint for this? Who is like Me and who can challenge Me? And what shepherd can stand against Me?</p> <p>Therefore, hear what the LORD has planned against Babylon, what He has purposed against the land of the Babylonians: The young of the flock will be dragged away. Their pasture will be appalled at their fate.</p> <p>At the sound of Babylon's capture the earth will tremble. Its cry will resound among the nations.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Bashan (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v2 — Isa 46:1; Isa 21:9

v4 — Jer 31:31; Hos 1:11; Hos 3:5

v5 — Jer 32:40; Isa 35:8
 v6 — Isa 53:6; Matt 9:36; Matt 10:6; Ezek 34:14; Jer 50:17
 v7 — Jer 14:8; Jer 2:3
 v8 — Isa 48:20; Jer 51:6; Rev 18:4
 v16 — Jer 46:16; Jer 51:9
 v20 — Mic 7:19; Jer 31:34; Isa 43:25; Isa 1:9; Ps 103:12
 v25 — Jer 51:55; Jer 51:25
 v33 — Isa 14:17; Ex 9:2-3; Isa 58:6; Ex 9:17-18; Isa 47:6
 v34 — Isa 54:5; Jer 51:36; Isa 47:4; Jer 15:21; Isa 41:14
 v37 — Jer 51:30; Nah 3:13

Chapter 51

The LORD declared He would raise up a destroying wind against Babylon and send fanners to fan her. Babylon was a golden cup in the LORD's hand that made all the earth drunk, but now she was suddenly fallen and broken. The LORD commanded His people to flee out of her midst. Jeremiah wrote all the coming disaster on a scroll and sent it to Babylon with Seraiah, commanding him to tie a stone to it and cast it into the Euphrates as a sign that Babylon would sink and never rise again.

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| 1 | <i>Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will raise up against Babylon, and against them that dwell in the midst of them that rise up against me, a destroying wind;</i> | This is what the LORD says: "See, I will stir up the spirit of a destroyer against Babylon and against those who live in Leb Kamai. |
| 2 | <i>And will send unto Babylon fanners, that shall fan her, and shall empty her land: for in the day of trouble they shall be against her round about.</i> | I will send foreigners to Babylon to winnow her and to devastate her land. They will oppose her on every side in the day of her disaster. |
| 3 | <i>Against him that bendeth let the archer bend his bow, and against him that lifteth himself up in his brigandine: and spare ye not her young men; destroy ye utterly all her host.</i> | Let not the archer string his bow, nor let Him put on his armor. Do not spare her young men. Completely destroy her army. |
| 4 | <i>Thus the slain shall fall in the land of the Chaldeans, and they that are thrust through in her streets.</i> | They will fall down slain in Babylon, fatally wounded in her streets. |

- 5 *For Israel hath not been forsaken, nor Judah of his God, of the LORD of hosts; though their land was filled with sin against the Holy One of Israel.* For Israel and Judah have not been forsaken by their God, the LORD of hosts, though their land is full of guilt before the Holy One of Israel.
- 6 *Flee out of the midst of Babylon, and deliver every man his soul: be not cut off in her iniquity; for this is the time of the LORD's vengeance; he will render unto her a recompense.* Flee from Babylon! Run for Your lives! Do not be destroyed because of her sins. It is time for the LORD's vengeance. He will repay her what she deserves.
- 7 *Babylon hath been a golden cup in the LORD's hand, that made all the earth drunken: the nations have drunken of her wine; therefore the nations are mad.* Babylon was a gold cup in the LORD's hand. She made the whole earth drunk. The nations drank her wine. Therefore they have now gone mad.
- 8 *Babylon is suddenly fallen and destroyed: howl for her; take balm for her pain, if so be she may be healed.* Babylon will suddenly fall and be broken. Wail over her! Get balm for her pain — perhaps she can be healed.
- 9 *We would have healed Babylon, but she is not healed: forsake her, and let us go every one into his own country: for her judgment reacheth unto heaven, and is lifted up even to the skies.* 'We would have healed Babylon, but she cannot be healed. Let us leave her and each go to our own land, for her judgment reaches to the skies. It rises as high as the heavens.'
- 10 *The LORD hath brought forth our righteousness: come, and let us declare in Zion the work of the LORD our God.* The LORD has vindicated us. Come, let us tell in Zion what the LORD our God has done.
- 11 *Make bright the arrows; gather the shields: the LORD hath raised up the spirit of the kings of the Medes: for his device is against Babylon, to destroy it; because it is the vengeance of the LORD, the vengeance of his temple.* "Sharpen the arrows! Take up the shields! The LORD has stirred up the kings of the Medes, because His purpose is to destroy Babylon. The LORD will take vengeance — vengeance for His temple.

- 12 *Set up the standard upon the walls of Babylon, make the watch strong, set up the watchmen, prepare the ambushes: for the LORD hath both devised and done that which he spake against the inhabitants of Babylon.* Lift up a banner against the walls of Babylon! Reinforce the guard. Station the watchmen. Prepare an ambush! The LORD will carry out His purpose, His decree against the people of Babylon.
- 13 *O thou that dwellest upon many waters, abundant in treasures, thine end is come, and the measure of thy covetousness.* You who live by many waters and are rich in treasures, Your end has come — the time for You to be cut off.
- 14 *The LORD of hosts hath sworn by himself, saying, Surely I will fill thee with men, as with caterpillers; and they shall lift up a shout against thee.* The LORD of hosts has sworn by Himself: I will fill You with troops, as with a swarm of locusts. They will shout in triumph over You.
- 15 *He hath made the earth by his power, he hath established the world by his wisdom, and hath stretched out the heaven by his understanding.* "He made the earth by His power. He founded the world by His wisdom and stretched out the heavens by His understanding.
- 16 *When he uttereth his voice, there is a multitude of waters in the heavens; and he causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth: he maketh lightnings with rain, and bringeth forth the wind out of his treasures.* When He thunders, the waters in the heavens roar. He makes clouds rise from the ends of the earth. He sends lightning with the rain and brings out the wind from His storehouses.
- 17 *Every man is brutish by his knowledge; every founder is confounded by the graven image: for his molten image is falsehood, and there is no breath in them.* Everyone is senseless and without knowledge. Every goldsmith is shamed by His idols. His images are a fraud — they have no breath in them.
- 18 *They are vanity, the work of errors: in the time of their visitation they shall perish.* They are worthless, the objects of mockery. When their judgment comes, they will perish.

- 19 *The portion of Jacob is not like them; for he is the former of all things: and Israel is the rod of his inheritance: the LORD of hosts is his name.* He who is the Portion of Jacob is not like these, for he is the Maker of all things — including the people of his inheritance. The LORD of hosts is His name.
- 20 *Thou art my battle axe and weapons of war: for with thee will I break in pieces the nations, and with thee will I destroy kingdoms;* "You are My war club, My weapon for battle — with You I shatter nations. With You I destroy kingdoms.
- 21 *And with thee will I break in pieces the horse and his rider; and with thee will I break in pieces the chariot and his rider;* With You I shatter horse and rider. With You I shatter chariot and driver.
- 22 *With thee also will I break in pieces man and woman; and with thee will I break in pieces old and young; and with thee will I break in pieces the young man and the maid;* With You I shatter man and woman. With You I shatter old man and youth. With You I shatter young man and young woman.
- 23 *I will also break in pieces with thee the shepherd and his flock; and with thee will I break in pieces the husbandman and his yoke of oxen; and with thee will I break in pieces captains and rulers.* With You I shatter shepherd and flock. With You I shatter farmer and oxen. With You I shatter governors and officials.
- 24 *And I will render unto Babylon and to all the inhabitants of Chaldea all their evil that they have done in Zion in your sight, saith the LORD.* But I will repay Babylon and all who live in Babylonia for all the wrong they have done in Zion," says the LORD.
- 25 *Behold, I am against thee, O destroying mountain, saith the LORD, which destroyest all the earth: and I will stretch out mine hand upon thee, and roll thee down from the rocks, and will make thee a burnt mountain.* "I am against You, destroying mountain, You who destroy the whole earth," says the LORD. "I will stretch out My hand against You, roll You off the cliffs, and make You a burned-out mountain.

- 26 *And they shall not take of thee a stone for a corner, nor a stone for foundations; but thou shalt be desolate for ever, saith the LORD.* No rock will be taken from You for a cornerstone, nor any stone for a foundation, for You will be desolate forever," says the LORD.
- 27 *Set ye up a standard in the land, blow the trumpet among the nations, prepare the nations against her, call together against her the kingdoms of Ararat, Minni, and Ashchenaz; appoint a captain against her; cause the horses to come up as the rough caterpillars.* "Lift up a banner in the land! Blow the trumpet among the nations! Prepare the nations for battle against her. Summon against her these kingdoms: Ararat, Minni, and Ashkenaz. Appoint a commander against her. Send up horses like a swarm of locusts.
- 28 *Prepare against her the nations with the kings of the Medes, the captains thereof, and all the rulers thereof, and all the land of his dominion.* Prepare the nations for battle against her — the kings of the Medes, their governors and all their officials, and all the countries they rule.
- 29 *And the land shall tremble and sorrow: for every purpose of the LORD shall be performed against Babylon, to make the land of Babylon a desolation without an inhabitant.* The land trembles and writhes, for the LORD's purposes against Babylon stand — to lay waste the land of Babylon so that no one will live there.
- 30 *The mighty men of Babylon have forborn to fight, they have remained in their holds: their might hath failed; they became as women: they have burned her dwellingplaces; her bars are broken.* Babylon's warriors have stopped fighting. They remain in their strongholds. Their strength is exhausted. They have become like women. Her dwellings are set on fire. The bars of her gates are broken.
- 31 *One post shall run to meet another, and one messenger to meet another, to shew the king of Babylon that his city is taken at one end,* One courier follows another. Messenger follows messenger to announce to the king of Babylon that his entire city is captured,
- 32 *And that the passages are stopped, and the reeds they have burned with fire, and the men of war are affrighted.* the river crossings seized, the marshes set on fire, and the soldiers terrified."

- 33 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; The daughter of Babylon is like a threshingfloor, it is time to thresh her: yet a little while, and the time of her harvest shall come.* This is what the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Daughter Babylon is like a threshing floor at the time it is trampled. The time to harvest her will soon come."
- 34 *Nebuchadrezzar the king of Babylon hath devoured me, he hath crushed me, he hath made me an empty vessel, he hath swallowed me up like a dragon, he hath filled his belly with my delicates, he hath cast me out.* "Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has devoured us, he has thrown us into confusion. He has made us an empty jar. Like a serpent he has swallowed us and filled his stomach with our delicacies, and then has spewed us out.
- 35 *The violence done to me and to my flesh be upon Babylon, shall the inhabitant of Zion say; and my blood upon the inhabitants of Chaldea, shall Jerusalem say.* May the violence done to our flesh be on Babylon," say the inhabitants of Zion. "May our blood be on those who live in Babylonia," says Jerusalem.
- 36 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will plead thy cause, and take vengeance for thee; and I will dry up her sea, and make her springs dry.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: "See, I will defend Your cause and take vengeance for You. I will dry up her sea and make her springs dry.
- 37 *And Babylon shall become heaps, a dwellingplace for dragons, an astonishment, and an hissing, without an inhabitant.* Babylon will become a heap of ruins, a haunt of jackals, an object of horror and scorn, a place where no one lives.
- 38 *They shall roar together like lions: they shall yell as lions' whelps.* Her people all roar like young lions. They growl like lion cubs.
- 39 *In their heat I will make their feasts, and I will make them drunken, that they may rejoice, and sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake, saith the LORD.* But while they are aroused, I will set out a feast for them and make them drunk, so that they shout with laughter — then sleep forever and not wake," says the LORD.
- 40 *I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams with he goats.* "I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams and goats.

- 41 *How is Sheshach taken! and how is the praise of the whole earth surprised! how is Babylon become an astonishment among the nations!* How Sheshach will be captured, the boast of the whole earth seized! What a horror Babylon will be among the nations!
- 42 *The sea is come up upon Babylon: she is covered with the multitude of his waves.* The sea will rise over Babylon. Its roaring waves will cover her.
- 43 *Her cities are a desolation, a dry land, and a wilderness, a land wherein no man dwelleth, neither doth any son of man pass thereby.* Her towns will be desolate, a dry and desert land — a land where no one lives and through which no one travels.
- 44 *And I will punish Bel in Babylon, and I will bring forth out of his mouth that which he hath swallowed up: and the nations shall not flow together any more unto him: yea, the wall of Babylon shall fall.* I will punish Bel in Babylon and make Him spew out what He has swallowed. The nations will no longer stream to him. And the wall of Babylon will fall.
- 45 *My people, go ye out of the midst of her, and deliver ye every man his soul from the fierce anger of the LORD.* Come out of her, My people! Run for Your lives! Run from the fierce anger of the LORD.
- 46 *And lest your heart faint, and ye fear for the rumour that shall be heard in the land; a rumour shall both come one year, and after that in another year shall come a rumour, and violence in the land, ruler against ruler.* Do not lose heart or be afraid when rumors are heard in the land. One rumor comes this year, another the next — rumors of violence in the land and of ruler against ruler.
- 47 *Therefore, behold, the days come, that I will do judgment upon the graven images of Babylon: and her whole land shall be confounded, and all her slain shall fall in the midst of her.* For the time will surely come when I will punish the idols of Babylon. Her whole land will be disgraced and all her slain will fall within her.

- 48 *Then the heaven and the earth, and all that is therein, shall sing for Babylon: for the spoilers shall come unto her from the north, saith the LORD.* Then heaven and earth and all that is in them will shout for joy over Babylon, for out of the north destroyers will attack her," says the LORD.
- 49 *As Babylon hath caused the slain of Israel to fall, so at Babylon shall fall the slain of all the earth.* Babylon must fall because of Israel's slain, just as the slain in all the earth have fallen because of Babylon.
- 50 *Ye that have escaped the sword, go away, stand not still: remember the LORD afar off, and let Jerusalem come into your mind.* You who have escaped the sword, leave and do not linger! Remember the LORD in a distant land and call Jerusalem to mind.
- 51 *We are confounded, because we have heard reproach: shame hath covered our faces: for strangers are come into the sanctuaries of the LORD's house.* "We are disgraced, for we have been insulted and shame covers our faces, because foreigners have entered the holy places of the LORD's house."
- 52 *Wherefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will do judgment upon her graven images: and through all her land the wounded shall groan.* "But days are coming," says the LORD, "when I will punish her idols, and throughout her land the wounded will groan."
- 53 *Though Babylon should mount up to heaven, and though she should fortify the height of her strength, yet from me shall spoilers come unto her, saith the LORD.* Even if Babylon reaches the sky and fortifies her lofty stronghold, I will send destroyers against her," says the LORD.
- 54 *A sound of a cry cometh from Babylon, and great destruction from the land of the Chaldeans:* "The sound of a cry comes from Babylon — the sound of great destruction from the land of the Babylonians.
- 55 *Because the LORD hath spoiled Babylon, and destroyed out of her the great voice; when her waves do roar like great waters, a noise of their voice is uttered:* The LORD is destroying Babylon. He will silence her noisy din. Waves of enemies will rage like great waters. The roar of their voices will resound,

- 56 *Because the spoiler is come upon her, even upon Babylon, and her mighty men are taken, every one of their bows is broken: for the LORD God of recompences shall surely requite.* for a destroyer will come against Babylon. Her warriors will be captured, and their bows will be broken. For the LORD is a God of retribution. He will repay in full.
- 57 *And I will make drunk her princes, and her wise men, her captains, and her rulers, and her mighty men: and they shall sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.* I will make her officials and wise men drunk, her governors, officers, and warriors as well. They will sleep forever and not wake," says the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.
- 58 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; The broad walls of Babylon shall be utterly broken, and her high gates shall be burned with fire; and the people shall labour in vain, and the folk in the fire, and they shall be weary.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Babylon's thick wall will be leveled and her high gates set on fire. The peoples exhaust themselves for nothing, the nations' labor is only fuel for the flames."
- 59 *The word which Jeremiah the prophet commanded Seraiah the son of Neriah, the son of Maaseiah, when he went with Zedekiah the king of Judah into Babylon in the fourth year of his reign. And this Seraiah was a quiet prince.* This is the message Jeremiah gave to the staff officer Seraiah son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, when He went to Babylon with Zedekiah king of Judah in the fourth year of his reign.
- 60 *So Jeremiah wrote in a book all the evil that should come upon Babylon, even all these words that are written against Babylon.* Jeremiah had written on a scroll about all the disasters that would come upon Babylon — all that had been recorded concerning Babylon.
- 61 *And Jeremiah said to Seraiah, When thou comest to Babylon, and shalt see, and shalt read all these words;* He said to Seraiah, "When You get to Babylon, see that You read all these words aloud.

- 62 *Then shalt thou say, O LORD, thou hast spoken against this place, to cut it off, that none shall remain in it, neither man nor beast, but that it shall be desolate for ever.* Then say, 'LORD, You have said You will destroy this place, so that neither people nor animals will live in it. It will be desolate forever.'
- 63 *And it shall be, when thou hast made an end of reading this book, that thou shalt bind a stone to it, and cast it into the midst of Euphrates:* When You finish reading this scroll, tie a stone to it and throw it into the Euphrates.
- 64 *And thou shalt say, Thus shall Babylon sink, and shall not rise from the evil that I will bring upon her: and they shall be weary. Thus far are the words of Jeremiah.* Then say, 'So will Babylon sink to rise no more because of the disaster I will bring on her. And her people will fall.'" The words of Jeremiah end here.

Words in this chapter:

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

v6 — Jer 50:8; Jer 50:28; Jer 50:15; Jer 25:14; Jer 51:45
v7 — Rev 14:8; Rev 17:4
v9 — Jer 50:16; Rev 18:5; Isa 13:14
v15 — Jer 10:12-16; Rev 4:11; Jer 32:17; Col 1:16-17; Rom 1:20
v20 — Isa 41:15-16; Mic 4:13; Isa 37:26; Zech 9:13-14; Isa 14:5-6
v25 — Rev 8:8; Zech 4:7; Jer 50:31
v27 — Gen 10:3; Gen 8:4; 1 Chr 1:6
v30 — Nah 3:13; Jer 50:36-37; Isa 13:7-8; Isa 19:16; Lam 2:9
v36 — Jer 50:38; Rom 12:19; Ps 140:12
v45 — Isa 48:20; Rev 18:4; Jer 51:6
v50 — Jer 44:28; Ps 122:6; Isa 51:11; Isa 52:11-12; Jer 51:45
v58 — Hab 2:13; Jer 50:15; Jer 51:44; Jer 51:64

Chapter 52

Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon. Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem, and in the fourth month the famine was severe. The city was broken up, Zedekiah was captured, and his sons were killed before his eyes. Nebuzaradan burned the temple, the palace, and every great house in Jerusalem, broke down the walls, and carried the people into exile. Jehoiachin was

released from prison in Babylon and given a place at the king's table for the rest of his life.

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| 1 <i>Zedekiah was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.</i> | Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem eleven years. His mother's name was Hamutal daughter of Jeremiah. She was from Libnah. |
| 2 <i>And he did that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.</i> | He did evil in the eyes of the LORD, just as Jehoiakim had done. |
| 3 <i>For through the anger of the LORD it came to pass in Jerusalem and Judah, till he had cast them out from his presence, that Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.</i> | It was because of the LORD's anger that all this happened to Jerusalem and Judah, and in the end He thrust them from His presence. Now Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon. |
| 4 <i>And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and pitched against it, and built forts against it round about.</i> | So in the ninth year of Zedekiah's reign, on the tenth day of the tenth month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched against Jerusalem with his whole army. They camped outside the city and built siege works all around it. |
| 5 <i>So the city was besieged unto the eleventh year of king Zedekiah.</i> | The city was kept under siege until the eleventh year of King Zedekiah. |
| 6 <i>And in the fourth month, in the ninth day of the month, the famine was sore in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land.</i> | By the ninth day of the fourth month the famine in the city had become so severe that there was no food for the people. |
| 7 <i>Then the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled, and went forth out of the city by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden; (now the Chaldeans were by the city round about:) and they went by the way of the plain.</i> | Then the city wall was broken through. Although the Babylonians had surrounded the city, all the soldiers fled. They left the city at night through the gate between the two walls near the king's garden. They fled toward the Arabah. |

- 8 *But the army of the Chaldeans pursued after the king, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him.* But the Babylonian army pursued King Zedekiah and overtook him in the plains of Jericho. All his soldiers were separated from him and scattered.
- 9 *Then they took the king, and carried him up unto the king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath; where he gave judgment upon him.* He was captured and taken to the king of Babylon at Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he pronounced sentence on him.
- 10 *And the king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes: he slew also all the princes of Judah in Riblah.* There at Riblah the king of Babylon slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes. He also killed all the officials of Judah.
- 11 *Then he put out the eyes of Zedekiah; and the king of Babylon bound him in chains, and carried him to Babylon, and put him in prison till the day of his death.* Then he put out Zedekiah's eyes, bound him with bronze shackles, and took him to Babylon where he put him in prison till the day of his death.
- 12 *Now in the fifth month, in the tenth day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, came Nebuzar-adan, captain of the guard, which served the king of Babylon, into Jerusalem,* On the tenth day of the fifth month, in the nineteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, Nebuzaradan commander of the imperial guard, who served the king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem.
- 13 *And burned the house of the LORD, and the king's house; and all the houses of Jerusalem, and all the houses of the great men, burned he with fire:* He set fire to the temple of the LORD, the royal palace, and all the houses of Jerusalem. Every important building He burned down.
- 14 *And all the army of the Chaldeans, that were with the captain of the guard, brake down all the walls of Jerusalem round about.* The whole Babylonian army under the commander of the imperial guard broke down all the walls around Jerusalem.

- 15 *Then Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive certain of the poor of the people, and the residue of the people that remained in the city, and those that fell away, that fell to the king of Babylon, and the rest of the multitude.* Nebuzaradan the commander of the guard carried into exile some of the poorest people and those who remained in the city, along with the rest of the craftsmen and those who had gone over to the king of Babylon.
- 16 *But Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard left certain of the poor of the land for vinedressers and for husbandmen.* But Nebuzaradan left behind the rest of the poorest people of the land to work the vineyards and fields.
- 17 *Also the pillars of brass that were in the house of the LORD, and the bases, and the brasen sea that was in the house of the LORD, the Chaldeans brake, and carried all the brass of them to Babylon.* The Babylonians broke up the bronze pillars, the movable stands, and the bronze Sea that were in the temple of the LORD and they carried all the bronze to Babylon.
- 18 *The caldrons also, and the shovels, and the snuffers, and the bowls, and the spoons, and all the vessels of brass wherewith they ministered, took they away.* They also took away the pots, shovels, wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls, dishes, and all the bronze articles used in the temple service.
- 19 *And the basons, and the firepans, and the bowls, and the caldrons, and the candlesticks, and the spoons, and the cups; that which was of gold in gold, and that which was of silver in silver, took the captain of the guard away.* The commander of the imperial guard took away the basins, censers, sprinkling bowls, pots, lampstands, dishes, and bowls used for drink offerings — whatever was made of pure gold or silver.
- 20 *The two pillars, one sea, and twelve brasen bulls that were under the bases, which king Solomon had made in the house of the LORD: the brass of all these vessels was without weight.* The bronze from the two pillars, the Sea, and the twelve bronze bulls under it, and the movable stands, which King Solomon had made for the temple of the LORD — all these could not be weighed.

- 21 *And concerning the pillars, the height of one pillar was eighteen cubits; and a fillet of twelve cubits did compass it; and the thickness thereof was four fingers: it was hollow.* Each pillar was eighteen cubits high and twelve cubits in circumference. Each was four fingers thick and hollow.
- 22 *And a chapter of brass was upon it; and the height of one chapter was five cubits, with network and pomegranates upon the chapter round about, all of brass. The second pillar also and the pomegranates were like unto these.* The bronze capital on top of one pillar was five cubits high and was decorated with a network and pomegranates of bronze all around. The other pillar, with its pomegranates, was similar.
- 23 *And there were ninety and six pomegranates on a side; and all the pomegranates upon the network were an hundred round about.* There were ninety-six pomegranates on the sides. The total number of pomegranates above the surrounding network was one hundred.
- 24 *And the captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the door:* The commander of the guard took as prisoners Seraiah the chief priest, Zephaniah the priest next in rank, and the three doorkeepers.
- 25 *He took also out of the city an eunuch, which had the charge of the men of war; and seven men of them that were near the king's person, which were found in the city; and the principal scribe of the host, who mustered the people of the land; and threescore men of the people of the land, that were found in the midst of the city.* Of those still in the city, he took the officer in charge of the fighting men and seven of the king's advisors. He also took the secretary who was chief officer in charge of conscripting the people of the land, and sixty of the common people who were found inside the city.
- 26 *So Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard took them, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah.* Nebuzaradan the commander took them all and brought them to the king of Babylon at Riblah.

- 27 *And the king of Babylon smote them, and put them to death in Riblah in the land of Hamath. Thus Judah was carried away captive out of his own land.* There at Riblah, in the land of Hamath, the king had them executed. So Judah went into exile, away from her land.
- 28 *This is the people whom Nebuchadrezzar carried away captive: in the seventh year three thousand Jews and three and twenty:* This is the number of the people Nebuchadnezzar carried into exile: in the seventh year, 3,023 Jews;
- 29 *In the eighteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar he carried away captive from Jerusalem eight hundred thirty and two persons:* in Nebuchadnezzar's eighteenth year, 832 people from Jerusalem;
- 30 *In the three and twentieth year of Nebuchadrezzar, Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the Jews seven hundred forty and five persons: all the persons were four thousand and six hundred.* in his twenty-third year, Nebuzaradan the commander of the imperial guard took into exile 745 Jews. There were 4,600 people in all.
- 31 *And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, in the five and twentieth day of the month, that Evilmerodach king of Babylon in the first year of his reign lifted up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah, and brought him forth out of prison.* In the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the year Awel-Marduk became king of Babylon, on the twenty-fifth day of the twelfth month, he released Jehoiachin king of Judah and freed him from prison.
- 32 *And spake kindly unto him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon.* He spoke kindly to him and gave him a seat of honor higher than those of the other kings who were with him in Babylon.
- 33 *And changed his prison garments: and he did continually eat bread before him all the days of his life.* So Jehoiachin put aside his prison clothes and for the rest of his life ate regularly at the king's table.

- 34 *And for his diet, there was a continual diet given him of the king of Babylon, every day a portion until the day of his death, all the days of his life.* Day by day the king of Babylon gave Jehoiachin a regular allowance as long as he lived, until the day of his death.
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Words in this chapter:

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

- v4** — Jer 39:1
- v11** — Ezek 12:13
- v12** — 2 Kgs 25:8
- v13** — Ps 79:1; 2 Chr 36:19; Mic 3:12
- v24** — 2 Kgs 25:18
- v25** — 2 Kgs 25:19
- v31** — 2 Kgs 25:27-30; Ps 3:3
- v34** — 2 Sam 9:10

Lamentations

Author: *Jeremiah, traditionally — Jewish and early Christian tradition uniformly attribute the book to him, consistent with his eyewitness presence at Jerusalem's fall and his deep grief over the city.*

Date written: *c. 586 BC, in the immediate aftermath of Jerusalem's destruction by Nebuchadnezzar.*

Written to: *The surviving remnant in Judah and the exiles in Babylon, giving voice to the grief of a nation in ruins.*

Setting: *Jerusalem has fallen. The temple is burned. The royal family is dead or in chains. The population is deported or left in a devastated land. Lamentations is written in the smoking rubble of everything Israel held sacred.*

Where this sits historically: *Written in 586 BC, the year Nebuchadnezzar of Babylon broke through the walls, burned Solomon's temple, blinded King Zedekiah, and deported most of Judah to Babylon.*

Contemporaries: *Jeremiah was still in the land (soon forced down to Egypt), Ezekiel and Daniel were already prophesying among the Babylonian exiles, and Obadiah had just announced Edom's doom for its role in Jerusalem's fall.*

Big themes:

- Grief without denial — *the book does not minimize the horror of what happened; it gives full expression to suffering, loss, and desolation as an act of honest faith*
- Confession — *Judah's suffering is acknowledged as deserved; the city sinned grievously and the LORD is righteous in His judgment*
- The mercy of God in darkness — *chapter 3 turns on one pivot: "It is of the LORD's mercies that we are not consumed" (3:22); even in the worst judgment, His compassion does not fail*
- Waiting on God — *the response to catastrophe is not despair but a return to God, who alone can restore*
- Acrostic structure — *four of the five chapters are Hebrew acrostic poems (each verse beginning with a successive letter of the alphabet), showing careful artistry even in lamentation*

Key passages: *Lam 1:12; 3:22–23; 3:40; 5:19–21*

How it fits: *Lamentations is the emotional sequel to the narrative of 2 Kings 25. Where 2 Kings records the events, Lamentations records the grief. It stands as the OT's guide to suffering — how to feel the full weight of loss while still turning toward God. Its central verse (3:22–23) became one of the NT church's most beloved statements of hope.*

Chapter 1

The poet mourns Jerusalem sitting alone like a widow, once great among the nations but now paying tribute. Her allies have betrayed her, her people have gone into captivity, and her enemies prosper because the LORD has afflicted her for her many transgressions. Jerusalem herself cries out that there is no sorrow like her sorrow and acknowledges that the LORD is righteous, for she has rebelled against His commands.

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| <p>1 <i>How doth the city sit solitary, that was full of people! how is she become as a widow! she that was great among the nations, and princess among the provinces, how is she become tributary!</i></p> | <p>How the city sits alone — once full of people! She has become like a widow. She was great among the nations, a princess among the provinces. Now she is made to pay tribute.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>She weepeth sore in the night, and her tears are on her cheeks: among all her lovers she hath none to comfort her: all her friends have dealt treacherously with her, they are become her enemies.</i></p> | <p>She weeps bitterly in the night. Tears run down her cheeks. Among all her lovers there is no one to comfort her. All her friends have betrayed her. They have become her enemies.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Judah is gone into captivity because of affliction, and because of great servitude: she dwelleth among the heathen, she findeth no rest: all her persecutors overtook her between the straits.</i></p> | <p>Judah has gone into exile because of her suffering and harsh slavery. She lives among the nations and finds no rest. All her pursuers caught her in a narrow place.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The ways of Zion do mourn, because none come to the solemn feasts: all her gates are desolate, her priests sigh, her virgins are afflicted, and she is in bitterness.</i></p> | <p>The roads to Zion mourn, for no one comes to her appointed festivals. All her gates are empty. Her priests sigh. Her young women grieve. She is in bitter anguish.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Her adversaries are the chief, her enemies prosper; for the LORD hath afflicted her for the multitude of her transgressions: her children are gone into captivity before the enemy.</i></p> | <p>Her enemies have become rulers. Her foes prosper. For the LORD has made her suffer because of her many transgressions. Her children have gone into captivity before the enemy.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — "crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command." When the Bible speaks of Israel's transgressions, it means they deliberately broke the covenant with God.

- 6 *And from the daughter of Zion all her beauty is departed: her princes are become like harts that find no pasture, and they are gone without strength before the pursuer.* All the splendor has left the daughter of Zion. Her princes are like deer that find no pasture. They flee without strength before the one who pursues them.
- 7 *Jerusalem remembered in the days of her affliction and of her miseries all her pleasant things that she had in the days of old, when her people fell into the hand of the enemy, and none did help her: the adversaries saw her, and did mock at her sabbaths.* Jerusalem, in the days of her suffering and wandering, remembers all the precious things she had in days of old. When her people fell into enemy hands and there was no one to help, her enemies looked on and mocked at her downfall.
- 8 *Jerusalem hath grievously sinned; therefore she is removed: all that honoured her despise her, because they have seen her nakedness: yea, she sigheth, and turneth backward.* Jerusalem has sinned greatly. Therefore she has become filthy. All who honored her now despise her, for they have seen her shame. She herself sighs and turns away.
- 9 *Her filthiness is in her skirts; she remembereth not her last end; therefore she came down wonderfully: she had no comforter. O LORD, behold my affliction: for the enemy hath magnified himself.* Her uncleanness clung to her skirts. She gave no thought to her future. Her fall was astonishing. She had no comforter. "O LORD, look on my suffering, for the enemy has triumphed."
- 10 *The adversary hath spread out his hand upon all her pleasant things: for she hath seen that the heathen entered into her sanctuary, whom thou didst command that they should not enter into thy congregation.* The enemy stretched out his hand over all her treasures. She watched as nations entered her sanctuary — the nations you commanded should not enter your congregation.
- 11 *All her people sigh, they seek bread; they have given their pleasant things for meat to relieve the soul: see, O LORD, and consider; for I am become vile.* All her people groan as they search for bread. They trade their treasures for food to keep themselves alive. "Look, O LORD, and take note, for I have become despised."

- 12 *Is it nothing to you, all ye that pass by? behold, and see if there be any sorrow like unto my sorrow, which is done unto me, wherewith the LORD hath afflicted me in the day of his fierce anger.* "Is it nothing to You, all who pass by? Look and see if there is any sorrow like my sorrow — the sorrow the LORD has brought on me in the day of His fierce anger."
- 13 *From above hath he sent fire into my bones, and it prevaieth against them: he hath spread a net for my feet, he hath turned me back: he hath made me desolate and faint all the day.* From above He sent fire into my bones and it spread through them. He spread a net for my feet and turned me back. He has left me desolate, in misery all day long.
- 14 *The yoke of my transgressions is bound by his hand: they are wreathed, and come up upon my neck: he hath made my strength to fall, the LORD hath delivered me into their hands, from whom I am not able to rise up.* The yoke of my transgressions has been fastened by His hand. They are twisted together and laid on my neck. He has drained my strength. The LORD has handed me over to those I cannot resist.
- 15 *The LORD hath trodden under foot all my mighty men in the midst of me: he hath called an assembly against me to crush my young men: the LORD hath trodden the virgin daughter of Judah, as in a winepress.* The Lord has rejected all my mighty warriors. He summoned an army against me to crush my young men. The Lord has trodden the virgin daughter of Judah like grapes in a winepress.
- 16 *For these things I weep; mine eye, mine eye runneth down with water, because the comforter that should relieve my soul is far from me: my children are desolate, because the enemy prevailed.* For these things I weep. My eyes overflow with tears. Any comforter who might restore me is far away. My children are desolate because the enemy has triumphed.
- 17 *Zion spreadeth forth her hands, and there is none to comfort her: the LORD hath commanded concerning Jacob, that his adversaries should be round about him: Jerusalem is as a menstruous woman among them.* Zion stretches out her hands, but there is no one to comfort her. The LORD has commanded that Jacob's neighbors should be his enemies. Jerusalem is as unclean in their midst.

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| <p>18 <i>The LORD is righteous; for I have rebelled against his commandment: hear, I pray you, all people, and behold my sorrow: my virgins and my young men are gone into captivity.</i></p> <p>19 <i>I called for my lovers, but they deceived me: my priests and mine elders gave up the ghost in the city, while they sought their meat to relieve their souls.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Behold, O LORD; for I am in distress: my bowels are troubled; mine heart is turned within me; for I have grievously rebelled: abroad the sword bereaveth, at home there is as death.</i></p> <p>21 <i>They have heard that I sigh: there is none to comfort me: all mine enemies have heard of my trouble; they are glad that thou hast done it: thou wilt bring the day that thou hast called, and they shall be like unto me.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Let all their wickedness come before thee; and do unto them, as thou hast done unto me for all my transgressions: for my sighs are many, and my heart is faint.</i></p> | <p>"The LORD is righteous, for I rebelled against His commands. Listen, all You peoples, and see my sorrow. My young women and my young men have gone into captivity."</p> <p>I called to my allies, but they deceived me. My priests and my elders perished in the city while searching for food to keep themselves alive.</p> <p>"Look, O LORD, for I am in distress. My stomach churns. My heart is wrung within me, for I have been very rebellious. In the streets the sword kills. At home there is death."</p> <p>They have heard my groaning. There is no one to comfort me. All my enemies have heard of my trouble. They are glad that You have done it. But You will bring the day You have announced, and they will become like me.</p> <p>"Let all their wickedness come before You. Deal with them as You have dealt with me for all my transgressions. For my groans are many and my heart is sick."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Comforter — The Helper who walks alongside — the Holy Spirit, sent by Christ; some translations say 'Helper' or 'Advocate,' but KJV says Comforter.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 3:26; 1 Kgs 4:21; Ezra 4:20; Rev 18:16-17

v2 — Ps 6:6

v8 — Lam 1:20-22; Isa 59:2-13

v9 — Deut 32:29; Ps 25:18; Isa 47:7

v10 — Deut 23:3; Jer 51:51

v11 — Jer 52:6; Jer 38:9; Lam 2:12

v12 — Dan 9:12; Luke 23:28-31

v13 — Job 30:30; Hab 3:16

v16 — Ps 119:136; Lam 1:2

v17 — Jer 4:31; Isa 1:15

v18 — Ps 119:75; Zeph 3:5; 1 Sam 12:14-15

v22 — Jer 8:18; Rev 6:10

Chapter 2

The poet describes the LORD acting as an enemy against His own people — swallowing up the dwellings of Jacob, destroying the temple, and making Zion forget her festivals. Her prophets gave false visions and did not expose her iniquity. Children faint in the streets, women eat their own offspring, and the poet cries out for Zion to pour out her heart like water before the Lord.

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| <p>1 <i>How hath the Lord covered the daughter of Zion with a cloud in his anger, and cast down from heaven unto earth the beauty of Israel, and remembered not his footstool in the day of his anger!</i></p> | <p>How the Lord has covered the daughter of Zion with a cloud of His anger! He has thrown down from heaven to earth the splendor of Israel. He did not remember His footstool in the day of His anger.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The Lord hath swallowed up all the habitations of Jacob, and hath not pitied: he hath thrown down in his wrath the strong holds of the daughter of Judah; he hath brought them down to the ground: he hath polluted the kingdom and the princes thereof.</i></p> | <p>The Lord has swallowed up without pity all the dwellings of Jacob. In his wrath he has torn down the strongholds of the daughter of Judah. He has brought them down to the ground. He has dishonored the kingdom and its princes.</p> |

- 3 *He hath cut off in his fierce anger all the horn of Israel: he hath drawn back his right hand from before the enemy, and he burned against Jacob like a flaming fire, which devoureth round about.* In His fierce anger He has cut off every defender of Israel. He has pulled back His right hand from before the enemy. He has burned against Jacob like a blazing fire that consumes everything around it.
- 4 *He hath bent his bow like an enemy: he stood with his right hand as an adversary, and slew all that were pleasant to the eye in the tabernacle of the daughter of Zion: he poured out his fury like fire.* He has bent his bow like an enemy. He has taken His stand like a foe with His right hand raised. He has killed all who were precious in the tabernacle of the daughter of Zion. He poured out His wrath like fire.
- 5 *The Lord was as an enemy: he hath swallowed up Israel, he hath swallowed up all her palaces: he hath destroyed his strong holds, and hath increased in the daughter of Judah mourning and lamentation.* The Lord has become like an enemy. He has swallowed up Israel. He has swallowed up all her palaces and destroyed her strongholds. He has multiplied in the daughter of Judah mourning and lamentation.
- 6 *And he hath violently taken away his tabernacle, as if it were of a garden: he hath destroyed his places of the assembly: the LORD hath caused the solemn feasts and sabbaths to be forgotten in Zion, and hath despised in the indignation of his anger the king and the priest.* He has torn down His tabernacle as easily as a garden shed. He has destroyed His appointed place. The LORD has made Zion forget her festivals and her Sabbaths. In His fierce anger He has rejected king and priest alike.
- 7 *The Lord hath cast off his altar, he hath abhorred his sanctuary, he hath given up into the hand of the enemy the walls of her palaces; they have made a noise in the house of the LORD, as in the day of a solemn feast.* The Lord has abandoned His altar and rejected His sanctuary. He has handed over the walls of her palaces to the enemy. They shout in the house of the LORD as on a day of appointed festival.

- 8 *The LORD hath purposed to destroy the wall of the daughter of Zion: he hath stretched out a line; he hath not withdrawn his hand from destroying: therefore he made the rampart and the wall to lament; they languished together.* The LORD purposed to destroy the wall of the daughter of Zion. He stretched out the measuring line. He did not hold back His hand from destroying. He made the rampart and the wall lament. They sank into ruin together.
- 9 *Her gates are sunk into the ground; he hath destroyed and broken her bars: her king and her princes are among the Gentiles: the law is no more; her prophets also find no vision from the LORD.* Her gates have sunk into the ground. He has destroyed and broken their bars. Her king and princes are among the nations. The law is no more. Her prophets receive no vision from the LORD.
- 10 *The elders of the daughter of Zion sit upon the ground, and keep silence: they have cast up dust upon their heads; they have girded themselves with sackcloth: the virgins of Jerusalem hang down their heads to the ground.* The elders of the daughter of Zion sit on the ground in silence. They have thrown dust on their heads and put on sackcloth. The young women of Jerusalem have bowed their heads to the ground.
- 11 *Mine eyes do fail with tears, my bowels are troubled, my liver is poured upon the earth, for the destruction of the daughter of my people; because the children and the sucklings swoon in the streets of the city.* My eyes are worn out from weeping. My stomach churns. My heart is poured out on the ground because of the destruction of the daughter of my people, as children and infants faint in the streets of the city.
- 12 *They say to their mothers, Where is corn and wine? when they swooned as the wounded in the streets of the city, when their soul was poured out into their mothers' bosom.* They cry to their mothers, "Where is food and drink?" as they faint like wounded men in the streets of the city, as their lives pour out on their mothers' laps.

- 13 *What thing shall I take to witness for thee? what thing shall I liken to thee, O daughter of Jerusalem? what shall I equal to thee, that I may comfort thee, O virgin daughter of Zion? for thy breach is great like the sea: who can heal thee?* "What can I say to You? What can I compare to You, O daughter of Jerusalem? What can I equal you to, that I might comfort you, O virgin daughter of Zion? Your wound is as deep as the sea. Who can heal You?"
- 14 *Thy prophets have seen vain and foolish things for thee: and they have not discovered thine iniquity, to turn away thy captivity; but have seen for thee false burdens and causes of banishment.* Your prophets have seen false and worthless visions for You. They did not expose Your iniquity to turn away Your captivity. The visions they proclaimed were lies and delusions.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — "deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than 'sin' — the corruption beneath the sinful act." When Lamentations speaks of iniquity, it points not just to what Israel did wrong, but to the deep moral corruption that drove their rebellion against God.

- 15 *All that pass by clap their hands at thee; they hiss and wag their head at the daughter of Jerusalem, saying, Is this the city that men call The perfection of beauty, The joy of the whole earth?* All who pass by clap their hands at You. They hiss and shake their heads at the daughter of Jerusalem, saying, "Is this the city they called the perfection of beauty, the joy of the whole earth?"
- 16 *All thine enemies have opened their mouth against thee: they hiss and gnash the teeth: they say, We have swallowed her up: certainly this is the day that we looked for; we have found, we have seen it.* All Your enemies open their mouths against You. They hiss and grind their teeth and say, "We have swallowed her up. This is the day we were waiting for. We have found it. We have seen it."

- 17 *The LORD hath done that which he had devised; he hath fulfilled his word that he had commanded in the days of old: he hath thrown down, and hath not pitied: and he hath caused thine enemy to rejoice over thee, he hath set up the horn of thine adversaries.* The LORD has done what He planned. He has carried out His word that He commanded long ago. He has torn down without pity. He has let Your enemy gloat over You and has given power to Your foes.
- 18 *Their heart cried unto the Lord, O wall of the daughter of Zion, let tears run down like a river day and night: give thyself no rest; let not the apple of thine eye cease.* Their heart cried out to the Lord. O wall of the daughter of Zion, let tears flow like a river day and night. Give Yourself no relief. Let Your eyes have no rest.
- 19 *Arise, cry out in the night: in the beginning of the watches pour out thine heart like water before the face of the Lord: lift up thy hands toward him for the life of thy young children, that faint for hunger in the top of every street.* Rise, cry out in the night. At the beginning of every watch, pour out Your heart like water before the face of the Lord. Lift Your hands to Him for the lives of Your children, who faint from hunger on every street corner.
- 20 *Behold, O LORD, and consider to whom thou hast done this. Shall the women eat their fruit, and children of a span long? shall the priest and the prophet be slain in the sanctuary of the Lord?* "Look, O LORD, and see who You have dealt with this way. Should women eat their own children, the babies they have carried? Should priest and prophet be killed in the sanctuary of the Lord?"
- 21 *The young and the old lie on the ground in the streets: my virgins and my young men are fallen by the sword; thou hast slain them in the day of thine anger; thou hast killed, and not pitied.* "Young and old lie together in the dust of the streets. My young women and my young men have fallen by the sword. You have killed them in the day of Your anger. You have slaughtered without pity."

- 22 *Thou hast called as in a solemn feast day my terrors round about, so that in the day of the LORD's anger none escaped nor remained: those that I have swaddled and brought up hath mine enemy consumed.* "You summoned terrors against me from every side, as though calling people to an appointed festival. In the day of the LORD's anger no one escaped. No one survived. The children I carried and raised, my enemy has destroyed."

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Chr 28:2; Ps 132:7
v2 — Lam 2:17; Ps 89:39-40; Lam 3:43
v6 — Lam 1:4; Zeph 3:18
v7 — Ps 74:3-8; Amos 2:5
v9 — Ezek 7:26; Hos 3:4
v11 — Lam 1:20; Jer 4:19; Job 16:13; Lam 1:16
v14 — Isa 58:1; Ezek 22:28; Jer 5:31
v15 — Ps 48:2; Jer 18:16
v16 — Ps 35:21; Lam 3:46; Ps 37:12
v17 — Ezek 5:11; Ps 89:42
v18 — Ps 119:145; Lam 3:48-49; Ps 119:136; Jer 9:1; Lam 2:8
v19 — Ps 62:8; Isa 26:9; Ps 119:147-148; Ps 142:2; Mark 1:35

Chapter 3

The poet speaks as one who has suffered under God's wrath — driven into darkness, walled in, and torn apart. Yet in the middle of his despair he declares that it is because of the LORD's mercies that we are not consumed, that His compassions are new every morning, and that great is His faithfulness. He calls the people to examine their ways and return to the LORD, then cries out for God to judge his enemies.

- 1 *I am the man that hath seen affliction by the rod of his wrath.* I am the man who has seen suffering under the rod of God's wrath.
- 2 *He hath led me, and brought me into darkness, but not into light.* He has driven me away and made me walk in darkness rather than light.

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| 3 <i>Surely against me is he turned; he turneth his hand against me all the day.</i> | He has turned His hand against me again and again, all day long. |
| 4 <i>My flesh and my skin hath he made old; he hath broken my bones.</i> | He has worn away my flesh and skin.
He has broken my bones. |
| 5 <i>He hath builded against me, and compassed me with gall and travail.</i> | He has built up walls against me and surrounded me with bitterness and hardship. |
| 6 <i>He hath set me in dark places, as they that be dead of old.</i> | He has made me sit in darkness like those who have been dead for ages. |
| 7 <i>He hath hedged me about, that I cannot get out: he hath made my chain heavy.</i> | He has walled me in so I cannot escape. He has weighed me down with heavy chains. |
| 8 <i>Also when I cry and shout, he shutteth out my prayer.</i> | Even when I cry out and call for help, He shuts out my prayer. |
| 9 <i>He hath inclosed my ways with hewn stone, he hath made my paths crooked.</i> | He has blocked my paths with cut stone. He has made my roads twisted and impassable. |
| 10 <i>He was unto me as a bear lying in wait, and as a lion in secret places.</i> | He has been to me like a bear lying in ambush, like a lion lurking in hiding. |
| 11 <i>He hath turned aside my ways, and pulled me in pieces: he hath made me desolate.</i> | He dragged me off my path and tore me apart. He has left me desolate. |
| 12 <i>He hath bent his bow, and set me as a mark for the arrow.</i> | He bent his bow and set me as a target for his arrows. |
| 13 <i>He hath caused the arrows of his quiver to enter into my reins.</i> | He drove the arrows from His quiver deep into my body. |
| 14 <i>I was a derision to all my people; and their song all the day.</i> | I have become the mockery of all my people — their song all day long. |
| 15 <i>He hath filled me with bitterness, he hath made me drunken with wormwood.</i> | He has filled me with bitterness. He has made me drink deeply of wormwood. |

- 16 *He hath also broken my teeth with gravel stones, he hath covered me with ashes.* He has ground my teeth on gravel. He has pressed my face into the dust.
- 17 *And thou hast removed my soul far off from peace: I forgot prosperity.* You have banished my soul from peace. I have forgotten what prosperity is.
- 18 *And I said, My strength and my hope is perished from the LORD:* I said, "My strength and my hope have perished from the LORD."
- 19 *Remembering mine affliction and my misery, the wormwood and the gall.* I remember my suffering and my wandering — the bitterness and the poison.
- 20 *My soul hath them still in remembrance, and is humbled in me.* My soul remembers and is brought low within me.
- 21 *This I recall to my mind, therefore have I hope.* Yet this I call to mind, and therefore I have hope:
- 22 *It is of the LORD's mercies that we are not consumed, because his compassions fail not.* It is because of the LORD's mercies that we are not consumed. His compassions never fail.
- 23 *They are new every morning: great is thy faithfulness.* They are new every morning. Great is Your faithfulness.
- 24 *The LORD is my portion, saith my soul; therefore will I hope in him.* "The LORD is my portion," says my soul. "Therefore I will hope in Him."
- 25 *The LORD is good unto them that wait for him, to the soul that seeketh him.* The LORD is good to those who wait for Him, to the soul that seeks Him.
- 26 *It is good that a man should both hope and quietly wait for the salvation of the LORD.* It is good to wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD.
- 27 *It is good for a man that he bear the yoke in his youth.* It is good for a man to bear the yoke while he is young.
- 28 *He sitteth alone and keepeth silence, because he hath borne it upon him.* Let Him sit alone in silence when God lays it on Him.

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| 29 | <i>He putteth his mouth in the dust; if so be there may be hope.</i> | Let Him put His face in the dust — there may yet be hope. |
| 30 | <i>He giveth his cheek to him that smiteth him: he is filled full with reproach.</i> | Let Him offer His cheek to one who strikes Him. Let Him be filled with disgrace. |
| 31 | <i>For the Lord will not cast off for ever:</i> | For the Lord will not reject forever. |
| 32 | <i>But though he cause grief, yet will he have compassion according to the multitude of his mercies.</i> | Even if He brings grief, He will show compassion — so great is His mercy. |
| 33 | <i>For he doth not afflict willingly nor grieve the children of men.</i> | For He does not willingly afflict or grieve the children of men. |
| 34 | <i>To crush under his feet all the prisoners of the earth,</i> | He does not want to crush under His feet all the prisoners of the earth |
| 35 | <i>To turn aside the right of a man before the face of the most High,</i> | or to deny a man his rights before the Most High |
| 36 | <i>To subvert a man in his cause, the Lord approveth not.</i> | or to deprive a man of justice. The Lord does not approve of these things. |
| 37 | <i>Who is he that saith, and it cometh to pass, when the Lord commandeth it not?</i> | Who can speak and have it happen if the Lord has not commanded it? |
| 38 | <i>Out of the mouth of the most High proceedeth not evil and good?</i> | Is it not from the mouth of the Most High that both disaster and good things come? |
| 39 | <i>Wherefore doth a living man complain, a man for the punishment of his sins?</i> | Why should any living person complain when punished for His sins? |
| 40 | <i>Let us search and try our ways, and turn again to the LORD.</i> | Let us examine and test our ways and turn back to the LORD. |
| 41 | <i>Let us lift up our heart with our hands unto God in the heavens.</i> | Let us lift up our hearts and our hands to God in heaven. |
| 42 | <i>We have transgressed and have rebelled: thou hast not pardoned.</i> | We have sinned and rebelled. You have not forgiven. |

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| 43 <i>Thou hast covered with anger, and persecuted us: thou hast slain, thou hast not pitied.</i> | You wrapped Yourself in anger and pursued us. You have killed without pity. |
| 44 <i>Thou hast covered thyself with a cloud, that our prayer should not pass through.</i> | You covered Yourself with a cloud so that no prayer could pass through. |
| 45 <i>Thou hast made us as the offscouring and refuse in the midst of the people.</i> | You have made us filth and garbage among the peoples. |
| 46 <i>All our enemies have opened their mouths against us.</i> | All our enemies have opened their mouths against us. |
| 47 <i>Fear and a snare is come upon us, desolation and destruction.</i> | We have experienced panic and the pit — devastation and destruction. |
| 48 <i>Mine eye runneth down with rivers of water for the destruction of the daughter of my people.</i> | Rivers of tears flow from my eyes because of the destruction of the daughter of my people. |
| 49 <i>Mine eye trickleth down, and ceaseth not, without any intermission,</i> | My eyes will keep flowing without stopping |
| 50 <i>Till the LORD look down, and behold from heaven.</i> | until the LORD looks down and sees from heaven. |
| 51 <i>Mine eye affecteth mine heart because of all the daughters of my city.</i> | My eyes bring me pain because of all the women of my city. |
| 52 <i>Mine enemies chased me sore, like a bird, without cause.</i> | My enemies hunted me relentlessly like a bird — though I had done nothing wrong. |
| 53 <i>They have cut off my life in the dungeon, and cast a stone upon me.</i> | They threw me alive into a pit and dropped a stone on top of me. |
| 54 <i>Waters flowed over mine head; then I said, I am cut off.</i> | The waters closed over my head. I said, "I am finished." |
| 55 <i>I called upon thy name, O LORD, out of the low dungeon.</i> | I called on Your name, O LORD, from the depths of the pit. |
| 56 <i>Thou hast heard my voice: hide not thine ear at my breathing, at my cry.</i> | You heard my voice. Do not hide Your ear from my cry for relief, from my plea. |

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| <p>57 <i>Thou drewest near in the day that I called upon thee: thou saidst, Fear not.</i></p> <p>58 <i>O Lord, thou hast pleaded the causes of my soul; thou hast redeemed my life.</i></p> <p>59 <i>O LORD, thou hast seen my wrong; judge thou my cause.</i></p> <p>60 <i>Thou hast seen all their vengeance and all their imaginations against me.</i></p> <p>61 <i>Thou hast heard their reproach, O LORD, and all their imaginations against me;</i></p> <p>62 <i>The lips of those that rose up against me, and their device against me all the day.</i></p> <p>63 <i>Behold their sitting down, and their rising up; I am their musick.</i></p> <p>64 <i>Render unto them a recompence, O LORD, according to the work of their hands.</i></p> <p>65 <i>Give them sorrow of heart, thy curse unto them.</i></p> <p>66 <i>Persecute and destroy them in anger from under the heavens of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>You came near when I called on You. You said, "Do not be afraid."</p> <p>O Lord, You have taken up my cause. You have reclaimed my life.</p> <p>O LORD, You have seen the wrong done to me. Uphold my cause.</p> <p>You have seen all their acts of revenge, all their schemes against me.</p> <p>You have heard their insults, O LORD, all their plots against me —</p> <p>the words of those who rise against me, their schemes against me all day long.</p> <p>Whether they sit or stand, look — I am the subject of their mocking songs.</p> <p>Pay them back what they deserve, O LORD, according to what their hands have done.</p> <p>Give them hearts that are hardened. Let Your curse be on them.</p> <p>Pursue them in anger and wipe them out from under the heavens of the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

v22 — Ps 86:15; Luke 1:50; Neh 9:31; Mic 7:18-19; Mal 3:6

v23 — Heb 10:23; Ps 30:5; Isa 33:2; Ps 36:5; Ps 89:33

v24 — Ps 73:26; Ps 16:5; Ps 142:5; Lam 3:21; Ps 33:18

v25 — Mic 7:7-8; Isa 40:31; Ps 130:5-6; Lam 3:26; Ps 37:34
 v26 — Ps 37:7; Ps 37:34; Ps 130:5; Heb 10:35; Gen 49:18
 v27 — Eccl 12:1; Matt 11:29-30; Ps 119:71; Ps 94:12; Heb 12:5-12
 v31 — Ps 94:14; Ps 103:8-10; Ps 77:7; Isa 54:7-10; 1 Sam 12:22
 v32 — Ps 78:38; Ps 30:5; Ps 103:11; Ex 3:7; Judg 10:16
 v37 — Ps 33:9-11; Isa 46:10; Prov 16:9; Prov 19:21; Prov 21:30
 v38 — Isa 45:7; Amos 3:6; Jer 32:42; Job 2:10; Ps 75:7
 v40 — 2 Cor 13:5; Ps 139:23-24; Joel 2:12-13; Isa 55:7; Ps 4:4
 v57 — Jas 4:8; Isa 41:10; Isa 58:9; Rev 2:10; Isa 41:14

Chapter 4

The poet mourns how the gold has grown dim and the precious sons of Zion are counted as clay pots. Famine has devastated the city — children beg for bread, compassionate women have boiled their own children, and the punishment exceeds that of Sodom. The LORD has poured out His full wrath because of the sins of her prophets and priests. The poet warns Edom that the cup will pass to her as well.

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| 1 | <i>How is the gold become dim! how is the most fine gold changed! the stones of the sanctuary are poured out in the top of every street.</i> | How the gold has grown dim! How the finest gold has changed! The sacred stones lie scattered at every street corner. |
| 2 | <i>The precious sons of Zion, comparable to fine gold, how are they esteemed as earthen pitchers, the work of the hands of the potter!</i> | The precious sons of Zion, once worth their weight in gold — now they are counted as mere clay pots, the work of a potter's hands. |
| 3 | <i>Even the sea monsters draw out the breast, they give suck to their young ones: the daughter of my people is become cruel, like the ostriches in the wilderness.</i> | Even jackals nurse their young, but the daughter of my people has become heartless — like an ostrich in the desert. |
| 4 | <i>The tongue of the sucking child cleaveth to the roof of his mouth for thirst: the young children ask bread, and no man breaketh it unto them.</i> | The nursing infant's tongue sticks to the roof of its mouth from thirst. Children beg for bread, but no one gives them any. |
| 5 | <i>They that did feed delicately are desolate in the streets: they that were brought up in scarlet embrace dunghills.</i> | Those who once ate fine food are starving in the streets. Those who grew up in luxury are picking through garbage heaps. |

- 6 *For the punishment of the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the punishment of the sin of Sodom, that was overthrown as in a moment, and no hands stayed on her.* The punishment for the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the penalty of Sodom, which was destroyed in a moment with no one to help her.
- 7 *Her Nazarites were purer than snow, they were whiter than milk, they were more ruddy in body than rubies, their polishing was of sapphire:* Her Nazarites were purer than snow and whiter than milk. They were more ruddy in body than rubies. Their appearance was like sapphire.
- 8 *Their visage is blacker than a coal; they are not known in the streets: their skin cleaveth to their bones; it is withered, it is become like a stick.* Now their faces are blacker than soot. They are not recognized in the streets. Their skin has shrunk to their bones. It has dried up and become like wood.
- 9 *They that be slain with the sword are better than they that be slain with hunger: for these pine away, stricken through for want of the fruits of the field.* Those killed by the sword are better off than those who die of hunger, who waste away, pierced by the lack of food from the fields.
- 10 *The hands of the pitiful women have sodden their own children: they were their meat in the destruction of the daughter of my people.* Compassionate women boiled their own children. Their children became their food during the destruction of the daughter of my people.
- 11 *The LORD hath accomplished his fury; he hath poured out his fierce anger, and hath kindled a fire in Zion, and it hath devoured the foundations thereof.* The LORD has given full vent to His wrath. He has poured out His fierce anger. He set a fire in Zion that consumed her very foundations.
- 12 *The kings of the earth, and all the inhabitants of the world, would not have believed that the adversary and the enemy should have entered into the gates of Jerusalem.* The kings of the earth could not believe — nor could any of the world's inhabitants — that an enemy or foe would ever enter the gates of Jerusalem.

- 13 *For the sins of her prophets, and the iniquities of her priests, that have shed the blood of the just in the midst of her.* It happened because of the sins of her prophets and the iniquities of her priests, who shed the blood of the righteous within her.
- 14 *They have wandered as blind men in the streets, they have polluted themselves with blood, insomuch that men could not touch their garments.* They staggered through the streets like blind men, so defiled with blood that no one could touch their clothing.
- 15 *They cried unto them, Depart ye; it is unclean; depart, depart, touch not: when they fled away and wandered, they said among the heathen, They shall no more sojourn there.* "Go away! Unclean!" people cried to them. "Go away! Away! Do not touch!" When they fled and wandered, the nations said, "They will stay here no longer."
- 16 *The anger of the LORD hath divided them; he will no more regard them: they respected not the persons of the priests, they favoured not the elders.* The LORD Himself scattered them. He will look on them no more. The people showed no respect to the priests and no honor to the elders.
- 17 *As for us, our eyes as yet failed for our vain help: in our watching we have watched for a nation that could not save us.* Our eyes strained with watching for help that never came. We kept watch from our towers for a nation that could not save us.
- 18 *They hunt our steps, that we cannot go in our streets: our end is near, our days are fulfilled; for our end is come.* They hunt our steps so we cannot walk in our own streets. Our end is near. Our days are numbered. Our end has come.
- 19 *Our persecutors are swifter than the eagles of the heaven: they pursued us upon the mountains, they laid wait for us in the wilderness.* Our pursuers were swifter than eagles in the sky. They chased us over the mountains. They lay in ambush for us in the desert.
- 20 *The breath of our nostrils, the anointed of the LORD, was taken in their pits, of whom we said, Under his shadow we shall live among the heathen.* The anointed of the LORD — the breath of our life — was caught in their traps, the one of whom we said, "Under His shadow we will live among the nations."

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| <p>21 <i>Rejoice and be glad, O daughter of Edom, that dwellest in the land of Uz; the cup also shall pass through unto thee: thou shalt be drunken, and shalt make thyself naked.</i></p> <p>22 <i>The punishment of thine iniquity is accomplished, O daughter of Zion; he will no more carry thee away into captivity: he will visit thine iniquity, O daughter of Edom; he will discover thy sins.</i></p> | <p>Rejoice and be glad, O daughter of Edom, you who live in the land of Uz. But the cup will pass to you as well. You will get drunk and expose Yourself.</p> <p>Your punishment is complete, O daughter of Zion. He will not send you into exile again. But He will punish your iniquity, O daughter of Edom. He will expose your sins.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 7:19-22
- v2 — Isa 30:14; Jer 19:11; Rom 9:21-23; 2 Tim 2:20
- v3 — Ezek 5:10; Luke 23:28-29
- v4 — Ps 22:15
- v5 — Luke 16:19
- v6 — Gen 19:25
- v7 — Ps 51:7
- v10 — Isa 49:15; Lam 2:20; 2 Kgs 6:26-29
- v16 — Lam 5:12; Isa 9:14-16
- v18 — Amos 8:2
- v19 — Jer 4:13; Hab 1:8; Isa 5:26-28
- v22 — Isa 40:2

Chapter 5

The poet pleads with the LORD to remember what has happened — their inheritance given to strangers, their people made orphans, servants ruling over them, and women violated in Zion. The joy of their hearts has ceased and their dancing has turned to mourning. Yet he affirms that the LORD reigns forever and pleads, "Turn us to Yourself, O LORD, and we shall be turned; renew our days as of old."

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| 1 <i>Remember, O LORD, what is come upon us: consider, and behold our reproach.</i> | Remember, O LORD, what has happened to us. Look and see our disgrace. |
| 2 <i>Our inheritance is turned to strangers, our houses to aliens.</i> | Our inheritance has been given over to strangers, our homes to foreigners. |
| 3 <i>We are orphans and fatherless, our mothers are as widows.</i> | We have become orphans without a father. Our mothers are like widows. |
| 4 <i>We have drunken our water for money; our wood is sold unto us.</i> | We have had to buy our own water to drink. Our own wood costs us money. |
| 5 <i>Our necks are under persecution: we labour, and have no rest.</i> | We are driven hard with a yoke on our necks. We labor with no rest. |
| 6 <i>We have given the hand to the Egyptians, and to the Assyrians, to be satisfied with bread.</i> | We stretched out our hands to Egypt and Assyria to get enough bread to eat. |
| 7 <i>Our fathers have sinned, and are not; and we have borne their iniquities.</i> | Our fathers sinned and are no more, but we bear their iniquities. |
| 8 <i>Servants have ruled over us: there is none that doth deliver us out of their hand.</i> | Servants rule over us. There is no one to rescue us from their hand. |
| 9 <i>We gat our bread with the peril of our lives because of the sword of the wilderness.</i> | We risk our lives to get our bread because of the sword in the desert. |
| 10 <i>Our skin was black like an oven because of the terrible famine.</i> | Our skin has become as hot as an oven because of the burning heat of famine. |
| 11 <i>They ravished the women in Zion, and the maids in the cities of Judah.</i> | Women were violated in Zion, young women in the cities of Judah. |
| 12 <i>Princes are hanged up by their hand: the faces of elders were not honoured.</i> | Princes were hung up by their hands. The faces of the elders were shown no honor. |
| 13 <i>They took the young men to grind, and the children fell under the wood.</i> | Young men were put to work at the grinding stone. Boys staggered under loads of wood. |

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| <p>14 <i>The elders have ceased from the gate,
the young men from their musick.</i></p> <p>15 <i>The joy of our heart is ceased; our
dance is turned into mourning.</i></p> <p>16 <i>The crown is fallen from our head:
woe unto us, that we have sinned!</i></p> <p>17 <i>For this our heart is faint; for these
things our eyes are dim.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Because of the mountain of Zion,
which is desolate, the foxes walk upon
it.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Thou, O LORD, remainest for ever;
thy throne from generation to
generation.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Wherefore dost thou forget us for
ever, and forsake us so long time?</i></p> <p>21 <i>Turn thou us unto thee, O LORD, and
we shall be turned; renew our days as
of old.</i></p> <p>22 <i>But thou hast utterly rejected us; thou
art very wroth against us.</i></p> | <p>The elders no longer sit at the city gate.
The young men no longer play music.</p> <p>The joy of our hearts has ended. Our
dancing has turned to mourning.</p> <p>The crown has fallen from our head.
How terrible it is for us, for we have
sinned!</p> <p>Because of this our hearts are sick.
Because of these things our eyes have
grown dim.</p> <p>Mount Zion lies desolate. Foxes prowl
over it.</p> <p>But You, O LORD, reign forever.
Your throne endures from generation
to generation.</p> <p>Why do You forget us forever? Why
do You forsake us so long?</p> <p>Turn us to Yourself, O LORD, and we
shall be turned. Renew our days as of
old.</p> <p>Unless You have completely rejected
us and are angry with us beyond
measure.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 44:13-16
- v2 — Isa 1:7; Zeph 1:13
- v4 — Isa 3:1
- v6 — Hos 9:3; Hos 12:1
- v7 — Jer 16:12; Jer 31:29; Ezek 18:2; Jer 14:20; Ex 20:5

v10 — Lam 4:8; Job 30:30

v11 — Isa 13:16

v16 — Ps 89:39; Isa 3:9-11

v17 — Ps 6:7; Isa 1:5

v19 — Ps 102:12; Ps 45:6; Heb 1:8-12; Ps 102:25-27; Ps 145:13

v20 — Ps 44:24; Ps 13:1

v21 — Ps 80:3; Ps 80:7; Ps 85:4; Ps 80:19; Jer 31:18

Ezekiel

Author: Ezekiel son of Buzi, a priest — the book is written almost entirely in first person and dated with remarkable precision to specific days of the Babylonian calendar.

Date written: c. 593–571 BC, during the Babylonian exile; the dates given within the book span twenty-two years.

Written to: The Jewish exiles in Babylon, particularly the community at Tel-abib by the river Chebar.

Setting: Ezekiel is already in Babylon with the first wave of exiles (597 BC) when his ministry begins. He prophesies for over twenty years — while Jerusalem still stands, through its fall (586 BC), and into the early restoration period. He ministers to a community in shock, stripped of temple, land, and king.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied from 593 to 571 BC at the height of Nebuchadnezzar's Neo-Babylonian empire, beside the river Chebar in southern Mesopotamia, before, during, and after the destruction of Jerusalem in 586 BC.

Contemporaries: Jeremiah preached in the dying days of Jerusalem, Daniel served in the Babylonian court, and Obadiah and Habakkuk both prophesied in the same Babylonian-era window.

Big themes:

- The glory of the LORD — the book opens with an overwhelming vision of God's throne-chariot (ch. 1) and traces where the glory goes: out of the temple (chs. 8–11), into exile, and back to a restored temple (chs. 40–48)
- Individual responsibility — "The soul that sinneth, it shall die" (18:4, 20); each person stands before God on their own account
- The valley of dry bones — the resurrection of a nation from death is one of the OT's most vivid prophetic images (ch. 37)
- Judgment on Israel and the nations — extended oracles against Jerusalem, Egypt, Tyre, and surrounding nations fill the middle section
- The restored temple — the final nine chapters describe an idealized temple in extraordinary detail, pointing to God's ultimate dwelling with His people

Key passages: Ezek 1:28; 11:19–20; 18:4; 36:26–27; 37:5

How it fits: Ezekiel is the exile's prophet, as Isaiah was the pre-exile prophet and Jeremiah the fall prophet. His temple vision in chapters 40–48 is the OT background to Revelation's new Jerusalem. His new heart/new spirit promise (36:26–27) is the OT's closest anticipation of the NT doctrine of regeneration.

Chapter 1

Ezekiel sees a vision of four living creatures and the glory of the LORD above them. The wheels within wheels move wherever the Spirit directs, and above the firmament sits a throne of sapphire with a figure like fire surrounded by brightness like a rainbow.

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| <p>1 <i>Now it came to pass in the thirtieth year, in the fourth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I was among the captives by the river of Chebar, that the heavens were opened, and I saw visions of God.</i></p> | <p>In the thirtieth year, on the fifth day of the fourth month, I was among the exiles by the river Chebar. The heavens opened, and I saw visions of God.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>In the fifth day of the month, which was the fifth year of king Jehoiachin's captivity,</i></p> | <p>It was the fifth day of the month — the fifth year of King Jehoiachin's exile.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The word of the LORD came expressly unto Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, in the land of the Chaldeans by the river Chebar; and the hand of the LORD was there upon him.</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD came clearly to Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, in the land of the Chaldeans by the river Chebar. The hand of the LORD was on Him there.</p> |
- **NAME NOTE** — **Ezekiel** (ee-ZEE-kee-ul) — "God strengthens" — A priest and prophet taken into exile in Babylon with King Jehoiachin in 597 BC. He received dramatic visions and preached to the Jewish exiles in Babylonia.
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| <p>4 <i>And I looked, and, behold, a whirlwind came out of the north, a great cloud, and a fire infolding itself, and a brightness was about it, and out of the midst thereof as the colour of amber, out of the midst of the fire.</i></p> | <p>I looked and saw a windstorm coming from the north — a great cloud with fire flashing from within it and brilliant light surrounding it. The center glowed like glowing metal from within the fire.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Also out of the midst thereof came the likeness of four living creatures. And this was their appearance; they had the likeness of a man.</i></p> | <p>From within it came the likeness of four living creatures. This was their appearance: they had the form of a human being.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And every one had four faces, and every one had four wings.</i></p> | <p>Each had four faces and four wings.</p> |

- 7 *And their feet were straight feet; and the sole of their feet was like the sole of a calf's foot: and they sparkled like the colour of burnished brass.* Their legs were straight. Their feet were like the hooves of a calf, gleaming like polished bronze.
- 8 *And they had the hands of a man under their wings on their four sides; and they four had their faces and their wings.* Under their wings on each of their four sides they had human hands. All four of them had faces and wings.
- 9 *Their wings were joined one to another; they turned not when they went; every one went straight forward.* Their wings touched one another. They did not turn when they moved. Each one went straight forward.
- 10 *As for the likeness of their faces, they four had the face of a man, and the face of a lion, on the right side: and they four had the face of an ox on the left side; they four also had the face of an eagle.* As for the form of their faces: each had a human face on the front, a lion's face on the right side, an ox's face on the left side, and an eagle's face on the back.
- 11 *Thus were their faces: and their wings were stretched upward; two wings of every one were joined one to another, and two covered their bodies.* Such were their faces. Their wings were spread upward. Two wings of each creature touched the wings of the creatures on either side, and two wings covered their bodies.
- 12 *And they went every one straight forward: whither the spirit was to go, they went; and they turned not when they went.* Each one moved straight forward. Wherever the Spirit would go, they went. They did not turn when they moved.
- 13 *As for the likeness of the living creatures, their appearance was like burning coals of fire, and like the appearance of lamps: it went up and down among the living creatures; and the fire was bright, and out of the fire went forth lightning.* The appearance of the living creatures was like burning coals of fire or like torches. Fire moved back and forth among them. The fire was bright, and lightning flashed from the fire.

- 14 *And the living creatures ran and returned as the appearance of a flash of lightning.* The living creatures moved back and forth like flashes of lightning.
- 15 *Now as I beheld the living creatures, behold one wheel upon the earth by the living creatures, with his four faces.* As I looked at the living creatures, I saw a wheel on the ground beside each of the four-faced creatures.
- 16 *The appearance of the wheels and their work was like unto the colour of a beryl: and they four had one likeness: and their appearance and their work was as it were a wheel in the middle of a wheel.* The wheels and their construction gleamed like topaz. All four wheels looked the same. Each wheel appeared to be a wheel intersecting a wheel.
- 17 *When they went, they went upon their four sides: and they turned not when they went.* When they moved, they moved in any of the four directions without turning.
- 18 *As for their rings, they were so high that they were dreadful; and their rings were full of eyes round about them four.* Their rims were high and awesome. All four rims were full of eyes all around.
- 19 *And when the living creatures went, the wheels went by them: and when the living creatures were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up.* When the living creatures moved, the wheels moved beside them. When the creatures rose from the ground, the wheels rose with them.
- 20 *Whithersoever the spirit was to go, they went, thither was their spirit to go; and the wheels were lifted up over against them: for the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels.* Wherever the Spirit would go, the creatures went, and the wheels rose alongside them — for the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.

- 21 *When those went, these went; and when those stood, these stood; and when those were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up over against them: for the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels.* When the creatures moved, the wheels moved. When the creatures stood still, the wheels stood still. When the creatures rose from the ground, the wheels rose with them — for the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.
- 22 *And the likeness of the firmament upon the heads of the living creature was as the colour of the terrible crystal, stretched forth over their heads above.* Spread out above the heads of the living creatures was something like a firmament, dazzling like crystal, stretched out overhead.
- 23 *And under the firmament were their wings straight, the one toward the other: every one had two, which covered on this side, and every one had two, which covered on that side, their bodies.* Under the firmament their wings were stretched out straight, one toward another. Each creature had two wings covering its body on each side.
- 24 *And when they went, I heard the noise of their wings, like the noise of great waters, as the voice of the Almighty, the voice of speech, as the noise of an host: when they stood, they let down their wings.* When they moved, I heard the sound of their wings like the roar of rushing waters, like the voice of the Almighty — a tumult like the noise of an army. When they stood still, they lowered their wings.
- 25 *And there was a voice from the firmament that was over their heads, when they stood, and had let down their wings.* There came a voice from above the firmament over their heads. When they stood still, they lowered their wings.
- 26 *And above the firmament that was over their heads was the likeness of a throne, as the appearance of a sapphire stone: and upon the likeness of the throne was the likeness as the appearance of a man above upon it.* Above the firmament over their heads was something like a throne — it looked like sapphire. On the likeness of the throne above was a figure that looked like a man.

- 27 *And I saw as the colour of amber, as the appearance of fire round about within it, from the appearance of his loins even upward, and from the appearance of his loins even downward, I saw as it were the appearance of fire, and it had brightness round about.* I saw that from what appeared to be His waist up, He looked like glowing metal, as if full of fire. From His waist down He looked like fire, and brilliant light surrounded Him.
- 28 *As the appearance of the bow that is in the cloud in the day of rain, so was the appearance of the brightness round about. This was the appearance of the likeness of the glory of the LORD. And when I saw it, I fell upon my face, and I heard a voice of one that spake.* Like the appearance of a rainbow in the clouds on a rainy day — that was how the brilliant light around Him looked. This was the appearance of the likeness of the glory of the LORD. When I saw it, I fell on my face, and I heard the voice of someone speaking.

Words in this chapter:

firmament — The expanse of sky — what God spread out above the earth on Day Two of creation to separate the waters.

Ezekiel (*eh-ZEE-kee-el*) — A priest and prophet among the exiles in Babylon — received dramatic visions of God's glory and the future restoration of Israel; his name means 'God strengthens.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Ezek 11:24; Matt 3:16; Rev 19:11; Acts 7:56; Luke 3:21

v3 — Ezek 3:14; Ezek 3:22; 2 Kgs 3:15; 1 Kgs 18:46; Ezek 33:22

v4 — Ezek 1:27; Ezek 8:2

v7 — Rev 1:15; Dan 10:6

v10 — Ezek 10:14; Rev 4:7

v13 — Ps 104:4; Rev 4:5

v14 — Matt 24:27; Zech 4:10

v18 — Ezek 10:12; Rev 4:8; Rev 4:6

v24 — Ezek 43:2; Dan 10:6; Ps 29:3-9; Rev 1:15; Rev 19:6

v26 — Ezek 10:1; Ex 24:10; Rev 1:13

v27 — Ezek 1:4; Ezek 8:2; Heb 12:29; Ps 97:2

v28 — Rev 10:1; Rev 4:3; Gen 17:3; Ezek 3:23

Chapter 2

The LORD commissions Ezekiel to speak to a rebellious Israel, whether they listen or refuse. He is given a scroll written on both sides with words of lamentation, mourning, and grief.

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| <p>1 <i>And he said unto me, Son of man, stand upon thy feet, and I will speak unto thee.</i></p> | <p>He said to me, "Son of man, stand on Your feet, and I will speak with You."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the spirit entered into me when he spake unto me, and set me upon my feet, that I heard him that spake unto me.</i></p> | <p>As He spoke to me, the Spirit entered me and set me on my feet. I heard Him speaking to me.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he said unto me, Son of man, I send thee to the children of Israel, to a rebellious nation that hath rebelled against me: they and their fathers have transgressed against me, even unto this very day.</i></p> | <p>He said to me, "Son of man, I am sending You to the children of Israel — to a rebellious nation that has rebelled against Me. They and their fathers have transgressed against Me to this very day."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For they are impudent children and stiffhearted. I do send thee unto them; and thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> | <p>"They are stubborn and hard-hearted children. I am sending You to them, and You shall say to them, 'This is what the Lord GOD says.'"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And they, whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear, (for they are a rebellious house,) yet shall know that there hath been a prophet among them.</i></p> | <p>"Whether they listen or refuse — for they are a rebellious house — they will know that a prophet has been among them."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And thou, son of man, be not afraid of them, neither be afraid of their words, though briers and thorns be with thee, and thou dost dwell among scorpions: be not afraid of their words, nor be dismayed at their looks, though they be a rebellious house.</i></p> | <p>"And You, Son of man, do not be afraid of them. Do not be afraid of their words, though briers and thorns surround You and You live among scorpions. Do not be afraid of their words or troubled by their looks, even though they are a rebellious house."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And thou shalt speak my words unto them, whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear: for they are most rebellious.</i></p> | <p>"You shall speak My words to them, whether they listen or refuse — for they are most rebellious."</p> |

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| 8 | <i>But thou, son of man, hear what I say unto thee; Be not thou rebellious like that rebellious house: open thy mouth, and eat that I give thee.</i> | "But You, Son of man — listen to what I say to You. Do not be rebellious like that rebellious house. Open Your mouth and eat what I give You." |
| 9 | <i>And when I looked, behold, an hand was sent unto me; and, lo, a roll of a book was therein:</i> | I looked and saw a hand stretched out to me. In it was a scroll. |
| 10 | <i>And he spread it before me; and it was written within and without: and there was written therein lamentations, and mourning, and woe.</i> | He unrolled it before me. It was written on both sides — front and back — with words of lamentation, mourning, and grief. |

Words in this chapter:

son of man — a title God uses for Ezekiel throughout this book; emphasizes his humanity before the Almighty

rebellious (*ree-BEL-yus*) — stubbornly defiant against God's authority; Israel is called a rebellious house

Cross-References:

v1 — Dan 10:11; Ezek 3:17; Ezek 4:1

v2 — Ezek 3:24

v3 — Jer 3:25

v4 — Ezek 3:7

v5 — Ezek 33:33; Ezek 3:27; Matt 10:12-15; John 15:22; Acts 13:46

v6 — Jer 1:8; Isa 51:12; 1 Pet 3:14; 2 Tim 1:7; Luke 10:19

v7 — Jer 23:28; Ezek 3:10; Ezek 2:5; Ezek 3:17; Jer 1:7

v8 — Rev 10:9; Jer 15:16; Isa 50:5; Ezek 3:1-3

v9 — Ezek 8:3

Chapter 3

Ezekiel eats the scroll and finds it sweet as honey. The LORD appoints him a watchman over Israel — if he fails to warn the wicked, their blood will be on his hands.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover he said unto me, Son of man, eat that thou findest; eat this roll, and go speak unto the house of Israel.</i> | He said to me, "Son of man, eat what is in front of You. Eat this scroll, and then go speak to the house of Israel." |
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- 2 *So I opened my mouth, and he caused me to eat that roll.* So I opened my mouth, and He fed me the scroll.
- 3 *And he said unto me, Son of man, cause thy belly to eat, and fill thy bowels with this roll that I give thee. Then did I eat it; and it was in my mouth as honey for sweetness.* He said to me, "Son of man, fill Your stomach and Your insides with this scroll I am giving You." I ate it, and it tasted as sweet as honey in my mouth.
- 4 *And he said unto me, Son of man, go, get thee unto the house of Israel, and speak with my words unto them.* He said to me, "Son of man, go now to the house of Israel and speak My words to them."
- 5 *For thou art not sent to a people of a strange speech and of an hard language, but to the house of Israel;* "You are not being sent to a people with a foreign language that is hard to understand, but to the house of Israel."
- 6 *Not to many people of a strange speech and of an hard language, whose words thou canst not understand. Surely, had I sent thee to them, they would have hearkened unto thee.* "Not to many peoples of strange speech and difficult language whose words You cannot understand. Surely, if I had sent You to them, they would have listened to You."
- 7 *But the house of Israel will not hearken unto thee; for they will not hearken unto me: for all the house of Israel are impudent and hardhearted.* "But the house of Israel will not listen to You, because they will not listen to Me. The whole house of Israel is stubborn and hard-hearted."
- 8 *Behold, I have made thy face strong against their faces, and thy forehead strong against their foreheads.* "I have made Your face as firm as their faces, and Your forehead as hard as their foreheads."
- 9 *As an adamant harder than flint have I made thy forehead: fear them not, neither be dismayed at their looks, though they be a rebellious house.* "I have made Your forehead like the hardest stone — harder than flint. Do not be afraid of them or troubled by their looks, even though they are a rebellious house."

- 10 *Moreover he said unto me, Son of man, all my words that I shall speak unto thee receive in thine heart, and hear with thine ears.* He said to me, "Son of man, take all My words that I speak to You into Your heart. Listen carefully with Your ears."
- 11 *And go, get thee to them of the captivity, unto the children of thy people, and speak unto them, and tell them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear.* "Go to the exiles, to the children of Your people. Speak to them and tell them, 'This is what the Lord GOD says' — whether they listen or refuse."
- 12 *Then the spirit took me up, and I heard behind me a voice of a great rushing, saying, Blessed be the glory of the LORD from his place.* Then the Spirit lifted me up, and I heard behind me a loud rumbling sound: "Blessed be the glory of the LORD from His place!"
- 13 *I heard also the noise of the wings of the living creatures that touched one another, and the noise of the wheels over against them, and a noise of a great rushing.* I heard the sound of the wings of the living creatures touching one another, and the sound of the wheels beside them — a great rumbling sound.
- 14 *So the spirit lifted me up, and took me away, and I went in bitterness, in the heat of my spirit; but the hand of the LORD was strong upon me.* The Spirit lifted me up and carried me away. I went in bitterness and anguish of spirit, but the hand of the LORD was strong upon me.
- 15 *Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel-abib, that dwelt by the river of Chebar, and I sat where they sat, and remained there astonished among them seven days.* I came to the exiles at Tel-abib, who lived by the river Chebar. I sat among them, overwhelmed, for seven days.
- 16 *And it came to pass at the end of seven days, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* At the end of seven days the word of the LORD came to me:
- 17 *Son of man, I have made thee a watchman unto the house of Israel: therefore hear the word at my mouth, and give them warning from me.* "Son of man, I have made You a watchman for the house of Israel. Hear the word from My mouth and warn them on My behalf."

- 18 *When I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; and thou givest him not warning, nor speakest to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life; the same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.* "When I say to the wicked, 'You will certainly die,' and you do not warn him or speak to warn him from his wicked ways to save his life — that wicked man will die in his iniquity. But I will hold you responsible for his blood."
- 19 *Yet if thou warn the wicked, and he turn not from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.* "But if you warn the wicked man and he does not turn from his wickedness or his wicked ways, he will die in his iniquity. But you will have saved yourself."
- 20 *Again, When a righteous man doth turn from his righteousness, and commit iniquity, and I lay a stumblingblock before him, he shall die: because thou hast not given him warning, he shall die in his sin, and his righteousness which he hath done shall not be remembered; but his blood will I require at thine hand.* "Again, when a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, and I put a stumbling block before him, he will die. Because you did not warn him, he will die in his sin. His righteous deeds will not be remembered, and I will hold you responsible for his blood."
- 21 *Nevertheless if thou warn the righteous man, that the righteous sin not, and he doth not sin, he shall surely live, because he is warned; also thou hast delivered thy soul.* "But if you warn the righteous man not to sin, and he does not sin, he will surely live because he took the warning. And you will have saved yourself."
- 22 *And the hand of the LORD was there upon me; and he said unto me, Arise, go forth into the plain, and I will there talk with thee.* The hand of the LORD came on me there, and He said to me, "Get up and go out to the plain. I will speak with You there."
- 23 *Then I arose, and went forth into the plain: and, behold, the glory of the LORD stood there, as the glory which I saw by the river of Chebar: and I fell on my face.* I got up and went out to the plain. The glory of the LORD was standing there — like the glory I had seen by the river Chebar. I fell on my face.

- 24 *Then the spirit entered into me, and set me upon my feet, and spake with me, and said unto me, Go, shut thyself within thine house.* The Spirit entered me and set me on my feet. He spoke to me and said, "Go, shut Yourself inside Your house."
- 25 *But thou, O son of man, behold, they shall put bands upon thee, and shall bind thee with them, and thou shalt not go out among them:* "As for You, Son of man, they will put ropes on You and bind You, and You will not go out among the people."
- 26 *And I will make thy tongue cleave to the roof of thy mouth, that thou shalt be dumb, and shalt not be to them a reprover: for they are a rebellious house.* "I will make Your tongue stick to the roof of Your mouth so that You will be silent and unable to rebuke them, for they are a rebellious house."
- 27 *But when I speak with thee, I will open thy mouth, and thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; He that heareth, let him hear; and he that forbeareth, let him forbear: for they are a rebellious house.* "But when I speak with You, I will open Your mouth and You shall say to them, 'This is what the Lord GOD says.' Whoever will listen, let them listen. Whoever will refuse, let them refuse — for they are a rebellious house."

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 10:9-10; Ezek 3:17-21; Ezek 2:8-9; 1 Tim 4:15
v3 — Jer 15:16; Rev 10:9-10; Ps 19:10; Ps 119:103
v9 — Ezek 2:6; Jer 1:8; Isa 41:10; Isa 50:7; Zech 7:12
v10 — Ps 119:11; Job 22:22; Luke 8:15; Ezek 3:1-3; Ezek 2:8
v12 — Ezek 8:3; Acts 8:39
v14 — Ezek 37:1; 2 Kgs 3:15; Jer 20:7-9; Ezek 8:3
v15 — Ps 137:1; Job 2:13
v17 — 2 Chr 19:10; Isa 52:8; Heb 13:17; Jer 6:17; Col 1:28
v18 — Ezek 33:6; Jas 5:19-20; Ezek 3:20; Acts 20:26-27; Ezek 33:8-10
v19 — Ezek 33:9; 1 Tim 4:16; Ezek 14:20

v20 — Ezek 18:24; Ezek 18:26; Ezek 33:12-13; Rom 2:7-8; Heb 10:38

v27 — Ezek 12:2-3; Ezek 24:27

Chapter 4

The LORD commands Ezekiel to act out the siege of Jerusalem on a clay tablet. He is to lie on his left side 390 days for Israel's iniquity and 40 days on his right side for Judah's, eating rationed bread baked over dung as a sign of the famine to come.

- 1 *Thou also, son of man, take thee a tile, and lay it before thee, and pourtray upon it the city, even Jerusalem:* "You, Son of man — take a clay tablet and set it in front of You. Draw the city of Jerusalem on it."
- 2 *And lay siege against it, and build a fort against it, and cast a mount against it; set the camp also against it, and set battering rams against it round about.* "Then put siege works against it. Build a siege wall. Raise up a ramp against it. Set up camps around it and put battering rams against it on every side."
- 3 *Moreover take thou unto thee an iron pan, and set it for a wall of iron between thee and the city: and set thy face against it, and it shall be besieged, and thou shalt lay siege against it. This shall be a sign to the house of Israel.* "Then take an iron plate and set it up as an iron wall between You and the city. Turn Your face toward it, and it will be under siege. Press the siege against it. This will be a sign to the house of Israel."
- 4 *Lie thou also upon thy left side, and lay the iniquity of the house of Israel upon it: according to the number of the days that thou shalt lie upon it thou shalt bear their iniquity.* "Then lie on Your left side and put the iniquity of the house of Israel on Yourself. For the number of days You lie on it, You will bear their iniquity."
- 5 *For I have laid upon thee the years of their iniquity, according to the number of the days, three hundred and ninety days: so shalt thou bear the iniquity of the house of Israel.* "I have assigned You one day for each year of their iniquity — 390 days. That is how long You will bear the iniquity of the house of Israel."

- 6 *And when thou hast accomplished them, lie again on thy right side, and thou shalt bear the iniquity of the house of Judah forty days: I have appointed thee each day for a year.* "When You have finished that, lie down again on Your right side and bear the iniquity of the house of Judah for forty days. I have assigned You one day for each year."
- 7 *Therefore thou shalt set thy face toward the siege of Jerusalem, and thine arm shall be uncovered, and thou shalt prophesy against it.* "Turn Your face toward the siege of Jerusalem with Your arm bared, and prophesy against it."
- 8 *And, behold, I will lay bands upon thee, and thou shalt not turn thee from one side to another, till thou hast ended the days of thy siege.* "I will tie You with ropes so You cannot turn from one side to the other until You have finished the days of Your siege."
- 9 *Take thou also unto thee wheat, and barley, and beans, and lentiles, and millet, and fitches, and put them in one vessel, and make thee bread thereof, according to the number of the days that thou shalt lie upon thy side, three hundred and ninety days shalt thou eat thereof.* "Take wheat, barley, beans, lentils, millet, and spelt. Put them in one container and make bread for Yourself. Eat it during the 390 days You lie on Your side."
- 10 *And thy meat which thou shalt eat shall be by weight, twenty shekels a day: from time to time shalt thou eat it.* "Eat it by weight — twenty shekels a day — measuring it out at set times."
- 11 *Thou shalt drink also water by measure, the sixth part of an hin: from time to time shalt thou drink.* "You will also drink water by measure — one sixth of a hin — drinking it at set times."
- 12 *And thou shalt eat it as barley cakes, and thou shalt bake it with dung that cometh out of man, in their sight.* "Eat it like a barley cake and bake it over human dung in their sight."
- 13 *And the LORD said, Even thus shall the children of Israel eat their defiled bread among the Gentiles, whither I will drive them.* The LORD said, "This is how the children of Israel will eat their defiled bread among the nations where I will drive them."

- 14 *Then said I, Ah Lord GOD! behold, I have never been polluted: for from my youth up even till now have I not eaten of that which dieth of itself, or is torn in pieces; neither came there abominable flesh into my mouth.* Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! I have never defiled myself. From my youth until now I have never eaten anything that died on its own or was torn by wild animals. No unclean meat has ever entered my mouth."
- 15 *Then he said unto me, Lo, I have given thee cow's dung for man's dung, and thou shalt prepare thy bread therewith.* He said to me, "Very well. I will let You use cow's dung instead of human dung. Prepare Your bread over that."
- 16 *Moreover he said unto me, Son of man, behold, I will break the staff of bread in Jerusalem: and they shall eat bread by weight, and with care; and they shall drink water by measure, and with astonishment:* He said to me, "Son of man, I am going to cut off the food supply in Jerusalem. They will eat bread by weight and in anxiety. They will drink water by measure and in despair."
- 17 *That they may want bread and water, and be astonied one with another, and consume away for their iniquity.* "This is so they will lack bread and water. They will be appalled at one another and waste away because of their iniquity."

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 21:22

v3 — Ezek 12:6; Isa 8:18; Isa 20:3

v6 — Num 14:34; Dan 12:11-12; Dan 9:24-26; Rev 11:2-3

v8 — Ezek 3:25

v9 — Ezek 4:13

v12 — Isa 36:12

v14 — Acts 10:14; Ezek 9:8; Deut 14:3; Ezek 20:49

v16 — Ezek 5:16; Isa 3:1; Lev 26:26

v17 — Ezek 24:23; Lev 26:39

Chapter 5

Ezekiel shaves his head and divides the hair into three parts — one burned, one struck with a sword, one scattered to the wind — picturing how Jerusalem's people will perish by famine, sword, and exile. The LORD declares He will execute unprecedented judgment because the city has defiled His sanctuary.

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| <p>1 <i>And thou, son of man, take thee a sharp knife, take thee a barber's razor, and cause it to pass upon thine head and upon thy beard: then take thee balances to weigh, and divide the hair.</i></p> | <p>"You, Son of man — take a sharp sword. Use it as a barber's razor and shave Your head and Your beard. Then take a scale and divide the hair into three parts."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Thou shalt burn with fire a third part in the midst of the city, when the days of the siege are fulfilled: and thou shalt take a third part, and smite about it with a knife: and a third part thou shalt scatter in the wind; and I will draw out a sword after them.</i></p> | <p>"When the days of the siege are over, burn one third of the hair in the middle of the city. Take another third and strike it with the sword all around the city. Scatter the last third to the wind, and I will pursue them with a drawn sword."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Thou shalt also take thereof a few in number, and bind them in thy skirts.</i></p> | <p>"Take a few strands of hair and tuck them in the folds of Your robe."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then take of them again, and cast them into the midst of the fire, and burn them in the fire; for thereof shall a fire come forth into all the house of Israel.</i></p> | <p>"Then take some of these and throw them into the fire and burn them. From there fire will spread to all the house of Israel."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; This is Jerusalem: I have set it in the midst of the nations and countries that are round about her.</i></p> | <p>This is what the Lord GOD says: "This is Jerusalem. I placed her at the center of the nations, with lands all around her."</p> |

- 6 *And she hath changed my judgments into wickedness more than the nations, and my statutes more than the countries that are round about her: for they have refused my judgments and my statutes, they have not walked in them.* "She has rebelled against My laws and decrees more wickedly than the nations around her. She has rejected My laws and has not lived by My decrees."
- 7 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye multiplied more than the nations that are round about you, and have not walked in my statutes, neither have kept my judgments, neither have done according to the judgments of the nations that are round about you;* Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "Because You have been more unruly than the nations around you, not living by My decrees or following My laws — not even following the practices of the surrounding nations —"
- 8 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I, even I, am against thee, and will execute judgments in the midst of thee in the sight of the nations.* Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "I Myself am against You, and I will execute judgment in Your midst in the sight of the nations."
- 9 *And I will do in thee that which I have not done, and whereunto I will not do any more the like, because of all thine abominations.* "Because of all Your abominations, I will do to You what I have never done before and will never do again."
- 10 *Therefore the fathers shall eat the sons in the midst of thee, and the sons shall eat their fathers; and I will execute judgments in thee, and the whole remnant of thee will I scatter into all the winds.* "In Your midst, fathers will eat their children and children will eat their fathers. I will execute judgment on You and scatter all Your survivors to every direction."

- 11 *Wherefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD; Surely, because thou hast defiled my sanctuary with all thy detestable things, and with all thine abominations, therefore will I also diminish thee; neither shall mine eye spare, neither will I have any pity.* "Therefore, as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, because You have defiled My sanctuary with all Your vile images and detestable practices, I will cut You down. My eye will not spare, and I will have no pity."
- 12 *A third part of thee shall die with the pestilence, and with famine shall they be consumed in the midst of thee: and a third part shall fall by the sword round about thee; and I will scatter a third part into all the winds, and I will draw out a sword after them.* "A third of Your people will die of plague and famine inside the city. A third will fall by the sword outside the walls. A third I will scatter to every direction and pursue with a drawn sword."
- 13 *Thus shall mine anger be accomplished, and I will cause my fury to rest upon them, and I will be comforted: and they shall know that I the LORD have spoken it in my zeal, when I have accomplished my fury in them.* "So My anger will be spent and My wrath against them satisfied. When I have vented My fury on them, they will know that I the LORD have spoken in My zeal."
- 14 *Moreover I will make thee waste, and a reproach among the nations that are round about thee, in the sight of all that pass by.* "I will make You a ruin and a disgrace among the nations around you, in the sight of all who pass by."
- 15 *So it shall be a reproach and a taunt, an instruction and an astonishment unto the nations that are round about thee, when I shall execute judgments in thee in anger and in fury and in furious rebukes. I the LORD have spoken it.* "You will be a reproach and a mockery, a warning and a horror to the nations around you when I execute judgment on you in anger and fury and with stinging rebukes. I the LORD have spoken."

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| <p>16 <i>When I shall send upon them the evil arrows of famine, which shall be for their destruction, and which I will send to destroy you: and I will increase the famine upon you, and will break your staff of bread:</i></p> <p>17 <i>So will I send upon you famine and evil beasts, and they shall bereave thee; and pestilence and blood shall pass through thee; and I will bring the sword upon thee. I the LORD have spoken it.</i></p> | <p>"I will send against You famine — deadly arrows of famine — sent to destroy You. I will increase the famine and cut off Your food supply."</p> <p>"I will send famine and wild animals against You, and they will leave You childless. Plague and bloodshed will sweep through You, and I will bring a sword against You. I the LORD have spoken."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 21:5; Isa 7:20; Ezek 44:20
- v2 — Ezek 5:12; Lev 26:33
- v5 — Ezek 4:1; Jer 6:6; Deut 4:6; Ezek 16:14
- v6 — Jer 11:10; Ezek 16:47-48
- v7 — Jer 2:10-11
- v9 — Matt 24:21; Dan 9:12
- v10 — Zech 2:6; Jer 19:9; Lev 26:29; Deut 28:64; Ezek 12:14
- v11 — Ezek 7:20
- v12 — Ezek 5:2; Jer 15:2; Jer 43:10-11
- v15 — Ezek 25:17
- v17 — Ezek 38:22

Chapter 6

The LORD pronounces judgment against the mountains of Israel and their high places. The altars and idols will be destroyed and the slain will fall among them, but a remnant will survive among the nations and remember the LORD.

- 1 *And the word of the LORD came unto* The word of the LORD came to me:
me, saying,

- 2 *Son of man, set thy face toward the mountains of Israel, and prophesy against them,* "Son of man, turn Your face toward the mountains of Israel and prophesy against them."
- 3 *And say, Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys; Behold, I, even I, will bring a sword upon you, and I will destroy your high places.* Say: "Mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD. This is what the Lord GOD says to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and valleys: I am bringing a sword against You, and I will destroy Your high places."
- 4 *And your altars shall be desolate, and your images shall be broken: and I will cast down your slain men before your idols.* "Your altars will be laid waste and Your incense altars will be broken. I will throw down Your slain before Your idols."
- 5 *And I will lay the dead carcasses of the children of Israel before their idols; and I will scatter your bones round about your altars.* "I will lay the dead bodies of the people of Israel before their idols and scatter Your bones around Your altars."
- 6 *In all your dwellingplaces the cities shall be laid waste, and the high places shall be desolate; that your altars may be laid waste and made desolate, and your idols may be broken and cease, and your images may be cut down, and your works may be abolished.* "In all Your settlements, the cities will be in ruins and the high places will be laid waste, so that Your altars will be ruined and desolate, Your idols smashed and abolished, Your incense altars cut down, and everything You have made wiped out."
- 7 *And the slain shall fall in the midst of you, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "The slain will fall among You, and You will know that I am the LORD."
- 8 *Yet will I leave a remnant, that ye may have some that shall escape the sword among the nations, when ye shall be scattered through the countries.* "But I will spare some — survivors of the sword among the nations when you are scattered through the lands."

- 9 *And they that escape of you shall remember me among the nations whither they shall be carried captives, because I am broken with their whorish heart, which hath departed from me, and with their eyes, which go a whoring after their idols: and they shall lothe themselves for the evils which they have committed in all their abominations.* "Then Your survivors will remember Me among the heathen where they are taken captive. I was broken by their whorish hearts that turned from Me, and by their eyes that went after their idols. They will despise themselves for the evil they have done and for all their abominations."
- 10 *And they shall know that I am the LORD, and that I have not said in vain that I would do this evil unto them.* "They will know that I am the LORD. I did not threaten in vain to bring this disaster on them."
- 11 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Smite with thine hand, and stamp with thy foot, and say, Alas for all the evil abominations of the house of Israel! for they shall fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.* This is what the Lord GOD says: "Clap Your hands and stamp Your foot and cry out, 'Alas!' over all the evil abominations of the house of Israel, for they will fall by sword, famine, and plague."
- 12 *He that is far off shall die of the pestilence; and he that is near shall fall by the sword; and he that remaineth and is besieged shall die by the famine: thus will I accomplish my fury upon them.* "Those far away will die of plague. Those nearby will fall by the sword. Those who survive and are spared will die of famine. I will spend My fury on them."
- 13 *Then shall ye know that I am the LORD, when their slain men shall be among their idols round about their altars, upon every high hill, in all the tops of the mountains, and under every green tree, and under every thick oak, the place where they did offer sweet savour to all their idols.* "You will know that I am the LORD when their dead lie among their idols — around their altars, on every high hill, on every mountaintop, under every green tree and every leafy oak — the places where they offered fragrant incense to all their idols."

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| <p>14 <i>So will I stretch out my hand upon them, and make the land desolate, yea, more desolate than the wilderness toward Diblah, in all their habitations: and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"I will stretch out My hand against them and make the land a desolate waste from the desert to Diblah — throughout all the places they live. Then they will know that I am the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

- v4 — 2 Chr 14:5
- v8 — Ezek 14:22
- v9 — Ezek 20:43; Isa 7:13; Isa 43:24; Job 42:6; Ps 78:40
- v11 — Ezek 5:12
- v13 — Ezek 20:28; Hos 4:13
- v14 — Isa 5:25

Chapter 7

The LORD declares that the end has come upon the land of Israel. Disaster upon disaster will strike — the sword outside, famine and plague inside — and neither silver nor gold will save them in the day of wrath.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD came to me:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Also, thou son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD unto the land of Israel; An end, the end is come upon the four corners of the land.</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, this is what the Lord GOD says to the land of Israel: The end! The end has come on the four corners of the land."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now is the end come upon thee, and I will send mine anger upon thee, and will judge thee according to thy ways, and will recompense upon thee all thine abominations.</i></p> | <p>"The end is now on You. I will unleash My anger against You and judge You according to Your ways. I will punish You for all Your abominations."</p> |

- 4 *And mine eye shall not spare thee, neither will I have pity: but I will recompense thy ways upon thee, and thine abominations shall be in the midst of thee: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "My eye will not spare You. I will have no pity. I will repay You for Your ways, and Your abominations will be among You. You will know that I am the LORD."
- 5 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; An evil, an only evil, behold, is come.* This is what the Lord GOD says: "Disaster! An unheard-of disaster — it is coming!"
- 6 *An end is come, the end is come: it watcheth for thee; behold, it is come.* "The end has come. The end has come. It has roused itself against You — it is here!"
- 7 *The morning is come unto thee, O thou that dwellest in the land: the time is come, the day of trouble is near, and not the sounding again of the mountains.* "Doom has come on You, You who live in the land. The time has come. The day is near. There is confusion, not joy, on the mountains."
- 8 *Now will I shortly pour out my fury upon thee, and accomplish mine anger upon thee: and I will judge thee according to thy ways, and will recompense thee for all thine abominations.* "Soon I will pour out My wrath on You and spend My anger against You. I will judge You according to Your ways and punish You for all Your abominations."
- 9 *And mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity: I will recompense thee according to thy ways and thine abominations that are in the midst of thee; and ye shall know that I am the LORD that smiteth.* "My eye will not spare, and I will have no pity. I will repay You according to Your ways and the abominations among You. Then You will know that it is I the LORD Who strikes."
- 10 *Behold the day, behold, it is come: the morning is gone forth; the rod hath blossomed, pride hath budded.* "The day is here. It has come. Doom has burst forth. The rod has budded. Arrogance has blossomed."

- 11 *Violence is risen up into a rod of wickedness: none of them shall remain, nor of their multitude, nor of any of theirs: neither shall there be wailing for them.* "Violence has grown into a rod of wickedness. None of the people will remain — not their wealth or anything of theirs. No one will mourn for them."
- 12 *The time is come, the day draweth near: let not the buyer rejoice, nor the seller mourn: for wrath is upon all the multitude thereof.* "The time has come. The day has arrived. Let not the buyer rejoice or the seller mourn, for wrath is on the whole crowd."
- 13 *For the seller shall not return to that which is sold, although they were yet alive: for the vision is touching the whole multitude thereof, which shall not return; neither shall any strengthen himself in the iniquity of his life.* "The seller will not recover what was sold even if He lives, for the vision concerns all the people. No one will turn back. Because of their iniquity, no one will be able to sustain their lives."
- 14 *They have blown the trumpet, even to make all ready; but none goeth to the battle: for my wrath is upon all the multitude thereof.* "They sound the trumpet and make everything ready, but no one goes into battle — for My wrath is on all of them."
- 15 *The sword is without, and the pestilence and the famine within: he that is in the field shall die with the sword; and he that is in the city, famine and pestilence shall devour him.* "The sword is outside. Plague and famine are inside. Those in the countryside will die by the sword. Those in the city will be consumed by famine and plague."
- 16 *But they that escape of them shall escape, and shall be on the mountains like doves of the valleys, all of them mourning, every one for his iniquity.* "Those who survive and escape will flee to the mountains. They will be like doves of the valleys, all of them moaning — each one over their own iniquity."
- 17 *All hands shall be feeble, and all knees shall be weak as water.* "Every hand will go limp. Every knee will be weak as water."

- 18 *They shall also gird themselves with sackcloth, and horror shall cover them; and shame shall be upon all faces, and baldness upon all their heads.* "They will put on sackcloth. Terror will cover them. Shame will be on every face and every head will be shaved."
- 19 *They shall cast their silver in the streets, and their gold shall be removed: their silver and their gold shall not be able to deliver them in the day of the wrath of the LORD: they shall not satisfy their souls, neither fill their bowels: because it is the stumblingblock of their iniquity.* "They will throw their silver into the streets, and their gold will be discarded. Neither their silver nor their gold will be able to save them in the day of the LORD's wrath. They cannot satisfy their hunger or fill their stomachs with it — for it became the stumbling block of their iniquity."
- 20 *As for the beauty of his ornament, he set it in majesty: but they made the images of their abominations and of their detestable things therein: therefore have I set it far from them.* "They took pride in their beautiful jewelry and used it to make their vile idols and detestable images. Therefore I will make it an unclean thing to them."
- 21 *And I will give it into the hands of the strangers for a prey, and to the wicked of the earth for a spoil; and they shall pollute it.* "I will give it as plunder to foreigners and as loot to the wicked of the earth, and they will defile it."
- 22 *My face will I turn also from them, and they shall pollute my secret place: for the robbers shall enter into it, and defile it.* "I will turn My face away from them, and they will desecrate My treasured place. Robbers will break into it and defile it."
- 23 *Make a chain: for the land is full of bloody crimes, and the city is full of violence.* "Prepare chains, for the land is full of bloody crimes and the city is full of violence."
- 24 *Wherefore I will bring the worst of the heathen, and they shall possess their houses: I will also make the pomp of the strong to cease; and their holy places shall be defiled.* "I will bring the most ruthless of heathen to take possession of their houses. I will put an end to the pride of the powerful, and their sanctuaries will be defiled."

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| <p>25 <i>Destruction cometh; and they shall seek peace, and there shall be none.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Mischief shall come upon mischief, and rumour shall be upon rumour; then shall they seek a vision of the prophet; but the law shall perish from the priest, and counsel from the ancients.</i></p> <p>27 <i>The king shall mourn, and the prince shall be clothed with desolation, and the hands of the people of the land shall be troubled: I will do unto them after their way, and according to their deserts will I judge them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"Anguish is coming. They will seek peace but there will be none."</p> <p>"Disaster will come on disaster, and rumor will follow rumor. They will seek a vision from the prophet, but the law will perish from the priest and counsel from the elders."</p> <p>"The king will mourn. The prince will be wrapped in despair. The hands of the people of the land will tremble. I will deal with them according to their own conduct, and I will judge them by their own standards. They will know that I am the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Amos 8:2
- v3 — Ezek 18:30
- v4 — Ezek 6:7
- v8 — Ezek 9:8; Ezek 14:19; Ezek 20:8; Ezek 20:21; Isa 42:25
- v10 — Isa 10:5
- v12 — Isa 5:13-14
- v15 — Jer 14:18; Ezek 5:12
- v16 — Isa 59:11; Ezra 9:15; Isa 38:14
- v17 — Ezek 21:7
- v19 — Prov 11:4; Zeph 1:18; Luke 12:19-20; Ezek 14:7; Isa 2:20
- v20 — Ezek 24:21
- v26 — Jer 4:20

Chapter 8

The Spirit transports Ezekiel in a vision to the temple in Jerusalem. He sees escalating abominations — an idol of jealousy at the gate, elders burning incense to carved images in secret, women weeping for Tammuz, and men bowing to the sun with their backs to the temple.

- 1 *And it came to pass in the sixth year, in the sixth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I sat in mine house, and the elders of Judah sat before me, that the hand of the Lord GOD fell there upon me.* In the sixth year, on the fifth day of the sixth month, I was sitting in my house with the elders of Judah sitting in front of me. The hand of the Lord GOD fell on me there.
- 2 *Then I beheld, and lo a likeness as the appearance of fire: from the appearance of his loins even downward, fire; and from his loins even upward, as the appearance of brightness, as the colour of amber.* I looked and saw a figure that looked like fire. From what appeared to be His waist down was fire. From His waist up He was brilliant — like glowing metal.
- 3 *And he put forth the form of an hand, and took me by a lock of mine head; and the spirit lifted me up between the earth and the heaven, and brought me in the visions of God to Jerusalem, to the door of the inner gate that looketh toward the north; where was the seat of the image of jealousy, which provoketh to jealousy.* He stretched out what looked like a hand and took me by the hair of my head. The Spirit lifted me up between earth and heaven and in visions of God brought me to Jerusalem — to the entrance of the north gate of the inner court, where the idol that provokes God's jealousy stood.
- 4 *And, behold, the glory of the God of Israel was there, according to the vision that I saw in the plain.* The glory of the God of Israel was there, like the vision I had seen in the plain.
- 5 *Then said he unto me, Son of man, lift up thine eyes now the way toward the north. So I lifted up mine eyes the way toward the north, and northward at the gate of the altar this image of jealousy in the entry.* He said to me, "Son of man, look toward the north." I looked toward the north, and there at the entrance north of the altar gate was this idol that provokes jealousy.

- 6 *He said furthermore unto me, Son of man, seest thou what they do? even the great abominations that the house of Israel committeth here, that I should go far off from my sanctuary? but turn thee yet again, and thou shalt see greater abominations.* He said to me, "Son of man, do You see what they are doing — the great abominations the house of Israel is committing here, driving Me far from My sanctuary? But You will see even greater abominations."
- 7 *And he brought me to the door of the court; and when I looked, behold a hole in the wall.* Then He brought me to the entrance of the court, and I looked and saw a hole in the wall.
- 8 *Then said he unto me, Son of man, dig now in the wall: and when I had digged in the wall, behold a door.* He said to me, "Son of man, dig through the wall." So I dug through the wall and saw a doorway.
- 9 *And he said unto me, Go in, and behold the wicked abominations that they do here.* He said to me, "Go in and see the wicked abominations they are doing here."
- 10 *So I went in and saw; and behold every form of creeping things, and abominable beasts, and all the idols of the house of Israel, pourtrayed upon the wall round about.* I went in and looked, and I saw every form of crawling creature and unclean animal and all the idols of the house of Israel — carved all over the walls.
- 11 *And there stood before them seventy men of the ancients of the house of Israel, and in the midst of them stood Jaazaniah the son of Shaphan, with every man his censer in his hand; and a thick cloud of incense went up.* Standing before them were seventy of the elders of the house of Israel. Jaazaniah son of Shaphan stood among them. Each man had his incense burner in his hand, and a fragrant cloud of incense was rising.
- 12 *Then said he unto me, Son of man, hast thou seen what the ancients of the house of Israel do in the dark, every man in the chambers of his imagery? for they say, The LORD seeth us not; the LORD hath forsaken the earth.* He said to me, "Son of man, have You seen what the elders of the house of Israel are doing in the dark? Each of them is in His own room full of carved idols. They say, 'The LORD doesn't see us. The LORD has abandoned the land.'"

- 13 *He said also unto me, Turn thee yet again, and thou shalt see greater abominations that they do.* He also said to me, "You will see even greater abominations than these."
- 14 *Then he brought me to the door of the gate of the LORD's house which was toward the north; and, behold, there sat women weeping for Tammuz.* Then He brought me to the entrance of the north gate of the LORD's house. There I saw women sitting and weeping for Tammuz.
- 15 *Then said he unto me, Hast thou seen this, O son of man? turn thee yet again, and thou shalt see greater abominations than these.* He said to me, "Do You see this, Son of man? You will see abominations even greater than these."
- 16 *And he brought me into the inner court of the LORD's house, and, behold, at the door of the temple of the LORD, between the porch and the altar, were about five and twenty men, with their backs toward the temple of the LORD, and their faces toward the east; and they worshipped the sun toward the east.* He brought me into the inner court of the LORD's house, and at the entrance to the temple, between the porch and the altar, were about twenty-five men. Their backs were toward the temple of the LORD and their faces toward the east. They were bowing down to the sun in the east.
- 17 *Then he said unto me, Hast thou seen this, O son of man? Is it a light thing to the house of Judah that they commit the abominations which they commit here? for they have filled the land with violence, and have returned to provoke me to anger: and, lo, they put the branch to their nose.* He said to me, "Have You seen this, Son of man? Is it a trivial thing for the house of Judah to do the abominations they are doing here? They have filled the land with violence and repeatedly provoked Me to anger. Look — they are even putting the branch to their nose."
- 18 *Therefore will I also deal in fury: mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity: and though they cry in mine ears with a loud voice, yet will I not hear them.* "Therefore I will deal with them in fury. My eye will not spare and I will have no pity. Even if they shout in My ears with a loud voice, I will not hear them."

Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Ezek 20:1

v2 — Ezek 1:4

v3 — Deut 32:16; Ezek 11:1

v6 — Ezek 5:11

v8 — Isa 29:15

v12 — Isa 29:15; Ezek 9:9; Ezek 8:15

v16 — Deut 4:19; Deut 17:3; Jer 32:33; Ezek 11:1; Jer 2:27

v17 — Ezek 9:9

v18 — Mic 3:4; Jer 11:11; Isa 1:15

Chapter 9

Six executioners with destroying weapons are summoned, along with a man in linen carrying a writing kit. The man marks the foreheads of those who grieve over Jerusalem's abominations, and the rest are slaughtered without pity — beginning at the sanctuary.

- 1 *He cried also in mine ears with a loud voice, saying, Cause them that have charge over the city to draw near, even every man with his destroying weapon in his hand.* He called in my hearing with a loud voice, "Bring the executioners of the city here, each with a weapon of destruction in his hand."
- 2 *And, behold, six men came from the way of the higher gate, which lieth toward the north, and every man a slaughter weapon in his hand; and one man among them was clothed with linen, with a writer's inkhorn by his side: and they went in, and stood beside the brasen altar.* Six men came from the direction of the upper gate, which faces north, each with a deadly weapon in his hand. With them was a man dressed in linen who carried a writing kit at his side. They came in and stood beside the bronze altar.

- 3 *And the glory of the God of Israel was gone up from the cherub, whereupon he was, to the threshold of the house. And he called to the man clothed with linen, which had the writer's inkhorn by his side;* Now the glory of the God of Israel went up from the cherub where it had been and moved to the threshold of the house. The LORD called to the man clothed in linen who had the writing kit.
- 4 *And the LORD said unto him, Go through the midst of the city, through the midst of Jerusalem, and set a mark upon the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry for all the abominations that be done in the midst thereof.* The LORD said to Him, "Go through the city — through Jerusalem — and put a mark on the foreheads of those who grieve and mourn over all the abominations being done in the city."
- 5 *And to the others he said in mine hearing, Go ye after him through the city, and smite: let not your eye spare, neither have ye pity:* To the others He said in my hearing, "Follow Him through the city and strike. Do not let Your eye spare, and have no pity."
- 6 *Slay utterly old and young, both maids, and little children, and women: but come not near any man upon whom is the mark; and begin at my sanctuary. Then they began at the ancient men which were before the house.* "Kill old men, young men, young women, little children, and women — but do not touch anyone who has the mark. Begin at My sanctuary." So they began with the elders who were in front of the house.
- 7 *And he said unto them, Defile the house, and fill the courts with the slain: go ye forth. And they went forth, and slew in the city.* He said to them, "Defile the house and fill the courts with the slain. Go!" So they went out and killed throughout the city.
- 8 *And it came to pass, while they were slaying them, and I was left, that I fell upon my face, and cried, and said, Ah Lord GOD! wilt thou destroy all the residue of Israel in thy pouring out of thy fury upon Jerusalem?* While they were killing and I was left alone, I fell on my face and cried out, "Ah, Lord GOD! Are You going to destroy all who remain in Israel when You pour out Your wrath on Jerusalem?"

- 9 *Then said he unto me, The iniquity of the house of Israel and Judah is exceeding great, and the land is full of blood, and the city full of perverseness: for they say, The LORD hath forsaken the earth, and the LORD seeth not.* He said to me, "The iniquity of the house of Israel and Judah is very great. The land is full of bloodshed and the city is full of injustice. They say, 'The LORD has forsaken the land. The LORD does not see.'"
- 10 *And as for me also, mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity, but I will recompense their way upon their head.* "My eye will not spare, and I will have no pity. I will bring their deeds on their own heads."
- 11 *And, behold, the man clothed with linen, which had the inkhorn by his side, reported the matter, saying, I have done as thou hast commanded me.* Then the man in linen with the writing kit came back and reported, "I have done as You commanded."

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

v3 — Ezek 10:4

v4 — Rev 9:4; 2 Cor 1:22; Rev 14:1; Rev 7:2-3; Rev 20:4

v5 — Ezek 5:11

v6 — Rev 9:4; Ex 12:23; Jer 25:29; 2 Tim 2:19; 1 Pet 4:17-18

v8 — Ezek 11:13

v9 — Ezek 8:12; Job 22:13

v10 — Ezek 7:4

Chapter 10

Ezekiel sees the glory of the LORD depart from the threshold of the temple and stand over the cherubim. Coals of fire are scattered over the city, and the cherubim with their wheels rise from the earth as the glory moves to the east gate.

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| 1 | <i>Then I looked, and, behold, in the firmament that was above the head of the cherubims there appeared over them as it were a sapphire stone, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne.</i> | I looked and saw that above the firmament over the heads of the cherubim there was something like a sapphire stone — the appearance of the likeness of a throne. |
| 2 | <i>And he spake unto the man clothed with linen, and said, Go in between the wheels, even under the cherub, and fill thine hand with coals of fire from between the cherubims, and scatter them over the city. And he went in in my sight.</i> | The LORD spoke to the man in linen and said, "Go between the wheels under the cherubim. Fill your hands with burning coals from between the cherubim and scatter them over the city." He went in as I watched. |
| 3 | <i>Now the cherubims stood on the right side of the house, when the man went in; and the cloud filled the inner court.</i> | The cherubim were standing on the south side of the house when the man went in. The cloud filled the inner court. |
| 4 | <i>Then the glory of the LORD went up from the cherub, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of the LORD's glory.</i> | The glory of the LORD rose from above the cherubim and moved to the threshold of the house. The house was filled with the cloud, and the court was filled with the radiance of the LORD's glory. |
| 5 | <i>And the sound of the cherubims' wings was heard even to the outer court, as the voice of the Almighty God when he speaketh.</i> | The sound of the wings of the cherubim could be heard as far as the outer court — like the voice of God Almighty when He speaks. |
| 6 | <i>And it came to pass, that when he had commanded the man clothed with linen, saying, Take fire from between the wheels, from between the cherubims; then he went in, and stood beside the wheels.</i> | When God commanded the man in linen, "Take fire from between the wheels, from between the cherubim," the man went in and stood beside the wheels. |

- 7 *And one cherub stretched forth his hand from between the cherubims unto the fire that was between the cherubims, and took thereof, and put it into the hands of him that was clothed with linen: who took it, and went out.* Then one of the cherubim reached out his hand to the fire between the cherubim. He took some of it and put it into the hands of the man in linen, who took it and went out.
- 8 *And there appeared in the cherubims the form of a man's hand under their wings.* The cherubim appeared to have the form of human hands under their wings.
- 9 *And when I looked, behold the four wheels by the cherubims, one wheel by one cherub, and another wheel by another cherub: and the appearance of the wheels was as the colour of a beryl stone.* I looked and saw four wheels beside the cherubim — one wheel beside each cherub. The wheels gleamed like topaz.
- 10 *And as for their appearances, they four had one likeness, as if a wheel had been in the midst of a wheel.* All four wheels looked the same — as if a wheel were within a wheel.
- 11 *When they went, they went upon their four sides; they turned not as they went, but to the place whither the head looked they followed it; they turned not as they went.* When they moved, they went in any of the four directions without turning. They followed the direction the head was facing and did not turn as they moved.
- 12 *And their whole body, and their backs, and their hands, and their wings, and the wheels, were full of eyes round about, even the wheels that they four had.* Their entire bodies — including their backs, hands, and wings — and the wheels were covered with eyes all around, all four of them.
- 13 *As for the wheels, it was cried unto them in my hearing, O wheel.* As for the wheels, they were called "the whirling wheels" as I heard.

- 14 *And every one had four faces: the first face was the face of a cherub, and the second face was the face of a man, and the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle.* Each of the cherubim had four faces: the first was the face of a cherub, the second a human face, the third a lion's face, and the fourth an eagle's face.
- 15 *And the cherubims were lifted up. This is the living creature that I saw by the river of Chebar.* The cherubim rose upward. These were the living creatures I had seen by the river Chebar.
- 16 *And when the cherubims went, the wheels went by them: and when the cherubims lifted up their wings to mount up from the earth, the same wheels also turned not from beside them.* When the cherubim moved, the wheels moved beside them. When the cherubim spread their wings to rise from the ground, the wheels did not leave their side.
- 17 *When they stood, these stood; and when they were lifted up, these lifted up themselves also: for the spirit of the living creature was in them.* When the cherubim stood still, the wheels stood still. When they rose, the wheels rose with them — for the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.
- 18 *Then the glory of the LORD departed from off the threshold of the house, and stood over the cherubims.* Then the glory of the LORD departed from the threshold of the house and stopped above the cherubim.
- 19 *And the cherubims lifted up their wings, and mounted up from the earth in my sight: when they went out, the wheels also were beside them, and every one stood at the door of the east gate of the LORD's house; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.* The cherubim spread their wings and rose up from the earth as I watched. The wheels were beside them as they went. They stopped at the entrance of the east gate of the LORD's house. The glory of the God of Israel was above them.
- 20 *This is the living creature that I saw under the God of Israel by the river of Chebar; and I knew that they were the cherubims.* These were the living creatures I had seen beneath the God of Israel by the river Chebar. I recognized that they were cherubim.

- 21 *Every one had four faces apiece, and every one four wings; and the likeness of the hands of a man was under their wings.* Each had four faces and four wings. Under their wings was the likeness of human hands.
- 22 *And the likeness of their faces was the same faces which I saw by the river of Chebar, their appearances and themselves: they went every one straight forward.* Their faces looked just like the faces I had seen by the river Chebar. Each one moved straight forward.

Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Rev 8:5
- v4 — Ezek 1:28
- v5 — Ezek 1:24
- v9 — Rev 21:20; Ezek 1:15-17; Dan 10:6
- v12 — Ezek 1:18
- v14 — Rev 4:7
- v15 — Ezek 1:5
- v20 — Ezek 1:1

Chapter 11

The glory of the LORD departs from the city and stands on the mountain east of Jerusalem. Yet the LORD promises to gather His scattered people, give them one heart, put a new spirit within them, and replace their heart of stone with a heart of flesh.

- 1 *Moreover the spirit lifted me up, and brought me unto the east gate of the LORD's house, which looketh eastward: and behold at the door of the gate five and twenty men; among whom I saw Jaazaniah the son of Azur, and Pelatiah the son of Benaiah, princes of the people.* The Spirit lifted me up and brought me to the east gate of the LORD's house, which faces east. At the entrance of the gate I saw twenty-five men. Among them were Jaazaniah son of Azzur and Pelatiah son of Benaiah — leaders of the people.

- 2 *Then said he unto me, Son of man, these are the men that devise mischief, and give wicked counsel in this city:* The LORD said to me, "Son of man, these are the men who plot evil and give wicked advice in this city."
- 3 *Which say, It is not near; let us build houses: this city is the caldron, and we be the flesh.* "They say, 'The time is not near to build houses. This city is the pot, and we are the meat.'"
- 4 *Therefore prophesy against them, prophesy, O son of man.* "Therefore prophesy against them. Prophesy, Son of man."
- 5 *And the Spirit of the LORD fell upon me, and said unto me, Speak; Thus saith the LORD; Thus have ye said, O house of Israel: for I know the things that come into your mind, every one of them.* The Spirit of the LORD came on me and said, "Speak: 'This is what the LORD says. That is what You have said, house of Israel. I know what comes into Your mind, every single one of those thoughts.'"
- 6 *Ye have multiplied your slain in this city, and ye have filled the streets thereof with the slain.* "You have killed many people in this city and filled its streets with the dead."
- 7 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Your slain whom ye have laid in the midst of it, they are the flesh, and this city is the caldron: but I will bring you forth out of the midst of it.* Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "The bodies You have thrown down in this city are the meat, and this city is the pot — but I will bring You out of it."
- 8 *Ye have feared the sword; and I will bring a sword upon you, saith the Lord GOD.* "You dread the sword, so I will bring a sword against You, declares the Lord GOD."
- 9 *And I will bring you out of the midst thereof, and deliver you into the hands of strangers, and will execute judgments among you.* "I will bring You out of the city and hand You over to foreigners. I will execute judgment on You."
- 10 *Ye shall fall by the sword; I will judge you in the border of Israel; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "You will fall by the sword. I will judge You at the border of Israel. You will know that I am the LORD."

- 11 *This city shall not be your caldron, neither shall ye be the flesh in the midst thereof; but I will judge you in the border of Israel:* "This city will not be Your pot, and You will not be the meat in it. I will judge You at the border of Israel."
- 12 *And ye shall know that I am the LORD: for ye have not walked in my statutes, neither executed my judgments, but have done after the manners of the heathen that are round about you.* "You will know that I am the LORD, for You have not lived by My statutes or followed My laws. Instead You have followed the practices of the heathen around you."
- 13 *And it came to pass, when I prophesied, that Pelatiah the son of Benaiah died. Then fell I down upon my face, and cried with a loud voice, and said, Ah Lord GOD! wilt thou make a full end of the remnant of Israel?* While I was prophesying, Pelatiah son of Benaiah died. I fell facedown and cried out, "Ah, Lord GOD! Will You completely destroy the remnant of Israel?"
- 14 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 15 *Son of man, thy brethren, even thy brethren, the men of thy kindred, and all the house of Israel wholly, are they unto whom the inhabitants of Jerusalem have said, Get you far from the LORD: unto us is this land given in possession.* "Son of man, the people of Jerusalem have said about your fellow exiles and all the house of Israel, "They are far from the LORD. This land has been given to us as our possession."
- 16 *Therefore say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Although I have cast them far off among the heathen, and although I have scattered them among the countries, yet will I be to them as a little sanctuary in the countries where they shall come.* "Therefore say: This is what the Lord GOD says: Although I sent them far away among the heathen and scattered them among the lands, yet I have been a small sanctuary for them in the countries where they have gone."

- 17 *Therefore say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even gather you from the people, and assemble you out of the countries where ye have been scattered, and I will give you the land of Israel.* "Therefore say: This is what the Lord GOD says: I will gather You from the peoples and assemble You from the lands where You have been scattered, and I will give You back the land of Israel."
- 18 *And they shall come thither, and they shall take away all the detestable things thereof and all the abominations thereof from thence.* "When they return, they will remove all its vile images and detestable idols."
- 19 *And I will give them one heart, and I will put a new spirit within you; and I will take the stony heart out of their flesh, and will give them an heart of flesh:* "I will give them one heart, and I will put a new spirit within them. I will remove their heart of stone and give them a heart of flesh."
- 20 *That they may walk in my statutes, and keep mine ordinances, and do them: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God.* "Then they will follow My statutes and keep My laws and carry them out. They will be My people, and I will be their God."
- 21 *But as for them whose heart walketh after the heart of their detestable things and their abominations, I will recompense their way upon their own heads, saith the Lord GOD.* "But as for those whose hearts are devoted to their vile images and detestable idols, I will bring their deeds on their own heads, declares the Lord GOD."
- 22 *Then did the cherubims lift up their wings, and the wheels beside them; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.* Then the cherubim spread their wings, and the wheels were beside them. The glory of the God of Israel was above them.
- 23 *And the glory of the LORD went up from the midst of the city, and stood upon the mountain which is on the east side of the city.* The glory of the LORD rose up from within the city and stopped on the mountain to the east of the city.

- 24 *Afterwards the spirit took me up, and brought me in a vision by the Spirit of God into Chaldea, to them of the captivity. So the vision that I had seen went up from me.* Then the Spirit lifted me up and brought me in a vision by the Spirit of God to the exiles in Babylonia. After this the vision I had seen went away from me.
- 25 *Then I spake unto them of the captivity all the things that the LORD had shewed me.* I told the exiles everything the LORD had shown me.

Words in this chapter:

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Isa 30:1
- v5 — Jer 17:10
- v6 — Ezek 7:23
- v9 — Ezek 5:8
- v11 — Ezek 11:3
- v13 — Ezek 11:1; Ezek 9:8
- v16 — Isa 8:14; Deut 30:3-4; Ps 90:1
- v17 — Ezek 28:25; Jer 3:18; Ezek 34:13
- v18 — Ezek 37:23; Ezek 5:11
- v19 — Ezek 36:26-27; Jer 31:33; Ps 51:10; Jer 32:39-40; Jer 24:7
- v20 — Ezek 14:11; Ps 105:45
- v23 — Zech 14:4

Chapter 12

The LORD commands Ezekiel to pack his belongings and dig through the wall in the sight of the people as a sign of exile. The prince in Jerusalem will carry his bags on his shoulder at twilight, and every vision and prophecy will shortly be fulfilled — no longer delayed.

- 1 *The word of the LORD also came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me: me, saying,

- 2 *Son of man, thou dwellest in the midst of a rebellious house, which have eyes to see, and see not; they have ears to hear, and hear not: for they are a rebellious house.* "Son of man, You live among a rebellious people. They have eyes to see but do not see, ears to hear but do not hear — for they are a rebellious house."
- 3 *Therefore, thou son of man, prepare thee stuff for removing, and remove by day in their sight; and thou shalt remove from thy place to another place in their sight: it may be they will consider, though they be a rebellious house.* "Son of man, pack Your belongings for exile and move out in the daytime as they watch. Move from Your place to another place in their sight. Perhaps they will understand, even though they are a rebellious house."
- 4 *Then shalt thou bring forth thy stuff by day in their sight, as stuff for removing: and thou shalt go forth at even in their sight, as they that go forth into captivity.* "Bring out Your belongings by day as if going into exile. Then go out in the evening as they watch — as those who go into captivity go out."
- 5 *Dig thou through the wall in their sight, and carry out thereby.* "Dig through the wall in their sight and carry Your belongings out through it."
- 6 *In their sight shalt thou bear it upon thy shoulders, and carry it forth in the twilight: thou shalt cover thy face, that thou see not the ground: for I have set thee for a sign unto the house of Israel.* "Carry Your pack on Your shoulders and go out in the dark. Cover Your face so You cannot see the ground — for I have made You a sign to the house of Israel."
- 7 *And I did so as I was commanded: I brought forth my stuff by day, as stuff for captivity, and in the even I digged through the wall with mine hand; I brought it forth in the twilight, and I bare it upon my shoulder in their sight.* I did as I was commanded. By day I brought out my belongings as though going into exile. In the evening I dug through the wall by hand. I carried my pack out in the dark and bore it on my shoulder as they watched.
- 8 *And in the morning came the word of the LORD unto me, saying,* In the morning the word of the LORD came to me:

- 9 *Son of man, hath not the house of Israel, the rebellious house, said unto thee, What doest thou?* "Son of man, did the house of Israel — that rebellious house — not ask You what You were doing?"
- 10 *Say thou unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; This burden concerneth the prince in Jerusalem, and all the house of Israel that are among them.* "Say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: This message concerns the prince in Jerusalem and the whole house of Israel who are there."
- 11 *Say, I am your sign: like as I have done, so shall it be done unto them: they shall remove and go into captivity.* "Say: I am a sign to You. As I have done, so it will be done to them. They will go into exile as captives."
- 12 *And the prince that is among them shall bear upon his shoulder in the twilight, and shall go forth: they shall dig through the wall to carry out thereby: he shall cover his face, that he see not the ground with his eyes.* "The prince among them will put his pack on his shoulder in the dark and go out through the wall. They will dig a hole through the wall to carry him through. He will cover his face so he cannot see the land."
- 13 *My net also will I spread upon him, and he shall be taken in my snare: and I will bring him to Babylon to the land of the Chaldeans; yet shall he not see it, though he shall die there.* "I will throw My net over him and catch him in My snare. I will bring him to Babylon in the land of the Chaldeans, but he will not see it — and there he will die."
- 14 *And I will scatter toward every wind all that are about him to help him, and all his bands; and I will draw out the sword after them.* "I will scatter in every direction all his helpers and all his troops, and I will pursue them with a drawn sword."
- 15 *And they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall scatter them among the nations, and disperse them in the countries.* "They will know that I am the LORD when I scatter them among the nations and disperse them through the lands."

- 16 *But I will leave a few men of them from the sword, from the famine, and from the pestilence; that they may declare all their abominations among the heathen whither they come; and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "But I will spare a few of them from sword, famine, and plague, so they may confess all their abominations among the heathen where they go. They will know that I am the LORD."
- 17 *Moreover the word of the LORD came to me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 *Son of man, eat thy bread with quaking, and drink thy water with trembling and with carefulness;* "Son of man, eat Your bread while trembling and drink Your water in fear and anxiety."
- 19 *And say unto the people of the land, Thus saith the Lord GOD of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and of the land of Israel; They shall eat their bread with carefulness, and drink their water with astonishment, that her land may be desolate from all that is therein, because of the violence of all them that dwell therein.* "Say to the people of the land: This is what the Lord GOD says about those living in Jerusalem and in the land of Israel. They will eat their food in anxiety and drink their water in despair. Their land will be stripped bare because of the violence of all who live there."
- 20 *And the cities that are inhabited shall be laid waste, and the land shall be desolate; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "The inhabited cities will lie in ruins and the land will become a wasteland. Then You will know that I am the LORD."
- 21 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 22 *Son of man, what is that proverb that ye have in the land of Israel, saying, The days are prolonged, and every vision faileth?* "Son of man, what is this proverb You have in the land of Israel: 'The days drag on and every vision fails to come true'?"

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| <p>23 <i>Tell them therefore, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will make this proverb to cease, and they shall no more use it as a proverb in Israel; but say unto them, The days are at hand, and the effect of every vision.</i></p> <p>24 <i>For there shall be no more any vain vision nor flattering divination within the house of Israel.</i></p> <p>25 <i>For I am the LORD: I will speak, and the word that I shall speak shall come to pass; it shall be no more prolonged: for in your days, O rebellious house, will I say the word, and will perform it, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying,</i></p> <p>27 <i>Son of man, behold, they of the house of Israel say, The vision that he seeth is for many days to come, and he prophesieth of the times that are far off.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Therefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; There shall none of my words be prolonged any more, but the word which I have spoken shall be done, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> | <p>"Say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am going to stop this proverb. It will no longer be used in Israel. Say to them, 'The days are near when every vision will be fulfilled.'"</p> <p>"There will be no more false visions or flattering predictions within the house of Israel."</p> <p>"For I am the LORD. I will speak, and the word I speak will be fulfilled. It will no longer be delayed. In Your own days, You rebellious house, I will speak the word and carry it out, declares the Lord GOD."</p> <p>The word of the LORD came to me:</p> <p>"Son of man, the house of Israel is saying, 'The vision He sees is for many years from now. He is prophesying about the distant future.'"</p> <p>"Therefore say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: None of My words will be delayed any longer. The word I have spoken will be fulfilled, declares the Lord GOD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sign (SYNE) — a symbolic action performed by the prophet to picture coming judgment; Ezekiel acts out the exile

prince (PRINS) — the ruler in Jerusalem; Zedekiah, the last king of Judah before the Babylonian captivity

Cross-References:

v2 — Jer 5:21; Mark 4:12; Ps 78:40; John 9:39-41; Jer 9:1-6
v3 — Jer 36:3
v4 — Jer 39:4
v6 — Ezek 4:3
v7 — Ezek 24:18
v9 — Ezek 24:19; Ezek 17:12
v12 — 2 Kgs 25:4; Jer 39:4
v13 — Ezek 17:20; Jer 39:7; Hos 7:12
v19 — Zech 7:14
v22 — Ezek 18:2-3; Ezek 11:3
v23 — Joel 2:1
v25 — Hab 1:5; Isa 55:11; Isa 14:24; Ezek 12:28; Matt 24:35

Chapter 13

The LORD condemns the false prophets of Israel who prophesy peace when there is no peace, whitewashing a flimsy wall. He also denounces the women who sew magic bands and veils to hunt souls for handfuls of barley and pieces of bread.

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| <p>1 <i>And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i></p> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel that prophesy, and say thou unto them that prophesy out of their own hearts, Hear ye the word of the LORD;</i></p> | "Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel who are now prophesying. Say to those who prophesy from their own imagination, 'Hear the word of the LORD!'" |
| <p>3 <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe unto the foolish prophets, that follow their own spirit, and have seen nothing!</i></p> | "This is what the Lord GOD says: How terrible it will be for the foolish prophets who follow their own spirit and have seen nothing!" |
| <p>4 <i>O Israel, thy prophets are like the foxes in the deserts.</i></p> | "Israel, Your prophets are like jackals among ruins." |
| <p>5 <i>Ye have not gone up into the gaps, neither made up the hedge for the house of Israel to stand in the battle in the day of the LORD.</i></p> | "You have not gone up to the breaks in the wall or repaired it for the house of Israel so it will stand firm in battle on the day of the LORD." |

- 6 *They have seen vanity and lying divination, saying, The LORD saith: and the LORD hath not sent them: and they have made others to hope that they would confirm the word.* "Their visions are false and their divinations a lie. They say, 'The LORD declares,' but the LORD has not sent them. Yet they expect their word to be confirmed."
- 7 *Have ye not seen a vain vision, and have ye not spoken a lying divination, whereas ye say, The LORD saith it; albeit I have not spoken?* "Have You not seen false visions and spoken lying divinations when You say, 'The LORD declares,' though I have not spoken?"
- 8 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye have spoken vanity, and seen lies, therefore, behold, I am against you, saith the Lord GOD.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You have spoken false visions and seen lies, I am against You, declares the Lord GOD."
- 9 *And mine hand shall be upon the prophets that see vanity, and that divine lies: they shall not be in the assembly of my people, neither shall they be written in the writing of the house of Israel, neither shall they enter into the land of Israel; and ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.* "My hand will be against the prophets who see false visions and give lying predictions. They will not belong to the council of My people or be listed in the records of Israel or enter the land of Israel. You will know that I am the Lord GOD."
- 10 *Because, even because they have seduced my people, saying, Peace; and there was no peace; and one built up a wall, and, lo, others daubed it with untempered mortar:* "Because they have led My people astray by saying 'Peace' when there is no peace — and because when a flimsy wall is built, they coat it with whitewash —"
- 11 *Say unto them which daub it with untempered mortar, that it shall fall: there shall be an overflowing shower; and ye, O great hailstones, shall fall; and a stormy wind shall rend it.* "tell those who coat it with whitewash that it will fall. A torrential rain will come. I will send great hailstones crashing down, and a violent wind will tear it apart."
- 12 *Lo, when the wall is fallen, shall it not be said unto you, Where is the daubing wherewith ye have daubed it?* "When the wall collapses, people will say to You, 'Where is the whitewash You covered it with?'"

- 13 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even rend it with a stormy wind in my fury; and there shall be an overflowing shower in mine anger, and great hailstones in my fury to consume it.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: In My wrath I will send a violent wind. In My anger a torrential rain will fall, and in My fury great hailstones will pound it to destruction."
- 14 *So will I break down the wall that ye have daubed with untempered mortar, and bring it down to the ground, so that the foundation thereof shall be discovered, and it shall fall, and ye shall be consumed in the midst thereof: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will tear down the wall You have covered with whitewash and level it to the ground so that its foundation will be exposed. When it falls, You will be destroyed in it. You will know that I am the LORD."
- 15 *Thus will I accomplish my wrath upon the wall, and upon them that have daubed it with untempered mortar, and will say unto you, The wall is no more, neither they that daubed it;* "I will spend My wrath on the wall and on those who covered it with whitewash. I will say to You, 'The wall is gone, and so are those who whitewashed it.'"
- 16 *To wit, the prophets of Israel which prophesy concerning Jerusalem, and which see visions of peace for her, and there is no peace, saith the Lord GOD.* "These are the prophets of Israel who prophesied to Jerusalem and saw visions of peace for her when there was no peace, declares the Lord GOD."
- 17 *Likewise, thou son of man, set thy face against the daughters of thy people, which prophesy out of their own heart; and prophesy thou against them,* "Now, Son of man, set Your face against the daughters of Your people who prophesy from their own imagination. Prophesy against them."

- 18 *And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the women that sew pillows to all armholes, and make kerchiefs upon the head of every stature to hunt souls! Will ye hunt the souls of my people, and will ye save the souls alive that come unto you?* "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: How terrible it will be for the women who sew magic bands on every wrist and make veils for people of every height to trap souls. Will You trap the souls of My people and keep Your own souls alive?"
- 19 *And will ye pollute me among my people for handfuls of barley and for pieces of bread, to slay the souls that should not die, and to save the souls alive that should not live, by your lying to my people that hear your lies?* "You have defiled Me among My people for handfuls of barley and pieces of bread. By lying to My people who love a lie, You have killed those who should not die and kept alive those who should not live."
- 20 *Wherefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against your pillows, wherewith ye there hunt the souls to make them fly, and I will tear them from your arms, and will let the souls go, even the souls that ye hunt to make them fly.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I am against Your magic bands with which You trap people like birds. I will tear them from Your arms and set free the people you have trapped."
- 21 *Your kerchiefs also will I tear, and deliver my people out of your hand, and they shall be no more in your hand to be hunted; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will tear off Your veils and rescue My people from Your hands. They will no longer fall prey to Your power. You will know that I am the LORD."
- 22 *Because with lies ye have made the heart of the righteous sad, whom I have not made sad; and strengthened the hands of the wicked, that he should not return from his wicked way, by promising him life:* "Because you disheartened the righteous with your lies when I had not caused them grief, and because you encouraged the wicked not to turn from their evil ways and so preserved their lives —"

- 23 *Therefore ye shall see no more vanity, nor divine divinations: for I will deliver my people out of your hand: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "therefore You will no longer see false visions or give predictions. I will rescue My people from Your hands. You will know that I am the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 13:17
 v3 — Lam 2:14; Jer 23:28-32
 v5 — Ezek 22:30; Ps 106:23; Isa 58:12
 v6 — Jer 29:8; Ezek 22:28; Jer 28:15
 v9 — Ps 87:6; Ps 69:28
 v13 — Isa 30:30
 v17 — Ezek 13:2
 v18 — 2 Pet 2:14
 v19 — Prov 28:21; Mic 3:5
 v20 — Ezek 13:18
 v22 — Jer 23:14
 v23 — Ezek 13:21

Chapter 14

Elders come to Ezekiel, but the LORD declares they have set up idols in their hearts. He warns that even if Noah, Daniel, and Job were in a sinful land, they could save only themselves by their own righteousness — not their sons or daughters.

- 1 *Then came certain of the elders of Israel unto me, and sat before me.* Some of the elders of Israel came to me and sat down in front of me.
- 2 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 3 *Son of man, these men have set up their idols in their heart, and put the stumblingblock of their iniquity before their face: should I be enquired of at all by them?* "Son of man, these men have set up idols in their hearts and placed the stumbling block of their iniquity right in front of them. Should I let them inquire of Me at all?"

- 4 *Therefore speak unto them, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Every man of the house of Israel that setteth up his idols in his heart, and putteth the stumblingblock of his iniquity before his face, and cometh to the prophet; I the LORD will answer him that cometh according to the multitude of his idols;* "Speak to them and say: This is what the Lord GOD says: When any Israelite sets up idols in His heart and puts the stumbling block of His iniquity before Him, and then comes to a prophet — I the LORD will answer Him according to His many idols."
- 5 *That I may take the house of Israel in their own heart, because they are all estranged from me through their idols.* "I will do this to recapture the hearts of the people of Israel who have all abandoned Me for their idols."
- 6 *Therefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Repent, and turn yourselves from your idols; and turn away your faces from all your abominations.* "Therefore say to the house of Israel: This is what the Lord GOD says: Repent. Turn from Your idols and turn away from all Your abominations."
- 7 *For every one of the house of Israel, or of the stranger that sojourneth in Israel, which separateth himself from me, and setteth up his idols in his heart, and putteth the stumblingblock of his iniquity before his face, and cometh to a prophet to enquire of him concerning me; I the LORD will answer him by myself;* "When any Israelite or any foreigner living in Israel separates Himself from Me, sets up idols in His heart, puts the stumbling block of His iniquity before Him, and comes to a prophet to ask Me something — I the LORD will answer Him Myself."
- 8 *And I will set my face against that man, and will make him a sign and a proverb, and I will cut him off from the midst of my people; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will set My face against that man and make him a sign and a byword. I will cut Him off from among My people. You will know that I am the LORD."

- 9 *And if the prophet be deceived when he hath spoken a thing, I the LORD have deceived that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand upon him, and will destroy him from the midst of my people Israel.* "And if a prophet is deceived and speaks a message, I the LORD have allowed that prophet to be deceived. I will stretch out My hand against Him and destroy Him from among My people Israel."
- 10 *And they shall bear the punishment of their iniquity: the punishment of the prophet shall be even as the punishment of him that seeketh unto him;* "Both the prophet and the person who consults him will bear the punishment for their iniquity."
- 11 *That the house of Israel may go no more astray from me, neither be polluted any more with all their transgressions; but that they may be my people, and I may be their God, saith the Lord GOD.* "This is so the house of Israel will no longer stray from Me and will no longer defile themselves with all their transgressions. They will be My people and I will be their God, declares the Lord GOD."
- 12 *The word of the LORD came again to me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 13 *Son of man, when the land sinneth against me by trespassing grievously, then will I stretch out mine hand upon it, and will break the staff of the bread thereof, and will send famine upon it, and will cut off man and beast from it:* "Son of man, when a land sins against Me by trespassing grievously, I will stretch out My hand against it and cut off its food supply. I will send famine on it and cut off man and beast from it."
- 14 *Though these three men, Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, they should deliver but their own souls by their righteousness, saith the Lord GOD.* "Even if these three men — Noah, Daniel, and Job — were in it, they could save only themselves by their righteousness, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *If I cause noisome beasts to pass through the land, and they spoil it, so that it be desolate, that no man may pass through because of the beasts:* "If I send wild animals through that country and they leave it childless and it becomes desolate so that no one will travel through it because of the animals —"

- 16 *Though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither sons nor daughters; they only shall be delivered, but the land shall be desolate.* "as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, even if these three men were in it, they could not save their own sons or daughters. They alone would be saved, but the land would be desolate."
- 17 *Or if I bring a sword upon that land, and say, Sword, go through the land; so that I cut off man and beast from it:* "Or if I bring a sword against that country and say, 'Let the sword pass through the land,' and I kill its people and their animals —"
- 18 *Though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither sons nor daughters, but they only shall be delivered themselves.* "as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, even if these three men were in it, they could not save their own sons or daughters. They alone would be saved."
- 19 *Or if I send a pestilence into that land, and pour out my fury upon it in blood, to cut off from it man and beast:* "Or if I send a plague into that land and pour out My wrath on it with bloodshed to kill its people and their animals —"
- 20 *Though Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither son nor daughter; they shall but deliver their own souls by their righteousness.* "as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, even if Noah, Daniel, and Job were in it, they could not save son or daughter. They would save only themselves by their righteousness."
- 21 *For thus saith the Lord GOD; How much more when I send my four sore judgments upon Jerusalem, the sword, and the famine, and the noisome beast, and the pestilence, to cut off from it man and beast?* "For this is what the Lord GOD says: How much worse will it be when I send My four dreadful judgments against Jerusalem — sword, famine, wild animals, and plague — to kill its people and their animals!"

- 22 *Yet, behold, therein shall be left a remnant that shall be brought forth, both sons and daughters: behold, they shall come forth unto you, and ye shall see their way and their doings: and ye shall be comforted concerning the evil that I have brought upon Jerusalem, even concerning all that I have brought upon it.* "Yet there will be survivors — sons and daughters who will be brought out. They will come to You, and when You see their behavior and their actions, You will be comforted about the disaster I have brought on Jerusalem — about everything I have brought on it."
- 23 *And they shall comfort you, when ye see their ways and their doings: and ye shall know that I have not done without cause all that I have done in it, saith the Lord GOD.* "They will comfort You when You see how they have behaved. You will know that I did not do without cause everything I have done in it, declares the Lord GOD."

Words in this chapter:

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 8:1; Isa 29:13; 2 Kgs 6:32; Ezek 20:1
- v3 — Ezek 14:7; Ezek 7:19; Ezek 20:3; Ezek 20:16; Isa 1:15
- v5 — Isa 1:4
- v6 — Ezek 18:30
- v8 — Ezek 15:7
- v11 — Ezek 37:23
- v13 — Lev 26:26; Ezek 4:16
- v14 — Ezek 14:20; Jer 15:1; Ezek 28:3; Gen 7:1; Ezek 14:18
- v15 — Ezek 5:17; Lev 26:22
- v17 — Lev 26:25; Ezek 21:3-4; Zeph 1:3; Ezek 5:12
- v20 — Ezek 14:14
- v21 — Ezek 5:17; Ezek 33:27

Chapter 15

The LORD compares Jerusalem to a useless vine — its wood cannot even be made into a peg. Since it was worthless even when whole, how much more useless is it now that fire has burned

it? *The LORD will make the land desolate because of their unfaithfulness.*

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| 1 | <i>And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>Son of man, What is the vine tree more than any tree, or than a branch which is among the trees of the forest?</i> | "Son of man, what good is the wood of a grapevine compared to any other wood — to a branch from any of the trees of the forest?" |
| 3 | <i>Shall wood be taken thereof to do any work? or will men take a pin of it to hang any vessel thereon?</i> | "Is wood from a vine ever used for anything useful? Can anyone make a peg from it to hang things on?" |
| 4 | <i>Behold, it is cast into the fire for fuel; the fire devoureth both the ends of it, and the middle of it is burned. Is it meet for any work?</i> | "No — it is thrown into the fire as fuel. The fire burns both ends and chars the middle. Is it then useful for anything?" |
| 5 | <i>Behold, when it was whole, it was meet for no work: how much less shall it be meet yet for any work, when the fire hath devoured it, and it is burned?</i> | "Even when it was whole it was not fit for any purpose. How much less can it be made into something useful when fire has burned and charred it?" |
| 6 | <i>Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; As the vine tree among the trees of the forest, which I have given to the fire for fuel, so will I give the inhabitants of Jerusalem.</i> | "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: As I have given the wood of the vine among the forest trees as fuel for fire, so I will treat the inhabitants of Jerusalem." |
| 7 | <i>And I will set my face against them; they shall go out from one fire, and another fire shall devour them; and ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I set my face against them.</i> | "I will set My face against them. Although they have escaped from one fire, another fire will consume them. You will know that I am the LORD when I set My face against them." |
| 8 | <i>And I will make the land desolate, because they have committed a trespass, saith the Lord GOD.</i> | "I will make the land desolate because they have committed a trespass, declares the Lord GOD." |

Words in this chapter:

vine (VYNE) — a common biblical image for Israel; here God says the vine wood is useless when it bears no fruit

Cross-References:

v7 — Ezek 14:8

Chapter 16

The LORD tells Jerusalem's history as an allegory: she was an abandoned infant whom He rescued, raised, and married. She became exceedingly beautiful but played the harlot with every nation around her, worse than Sodom and Samaria — yet the LORD will remember His covenant and establish an everlasting covenant with her.

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| 1 | <i>Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>Son of man, cause Jerusalem to know her abominations,</i> | "Son of man, confront Jerusalem with her abominations." |
| 3 | <i>And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD unto Jerusalem; Thy birth and thy nativity is of the land of Canaan; thy father was an Amorite, and thy mother an Hittite.</i> | "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says to Jerusalem: Your origin and birth were in the land of Canaan. Your father was an Amorite and Your mother a Hittite." |
| 4 | <i>And as for thy nativity, in the day thou wast born thy navel was not cut, neither wast thou washed in water to supple thee; thou wast not salted at all, nor swaddled at all.</i> | "On the day You were born, Your umbilical cord was not cut, You were not washed with water, You were not rubbed with salt, and You were not wrapped in cloths." |
| 5 | <i>None eye pitied thee, to do any of these unto thee, to have compassion upon thee; but thou wast cast out in the open field, to the lothing of thy person, in the day that thou wast born.</i> | "No one looked on you with pity or had compassion enough to do any of these things for You. You were thrown out into the open field on the day You were born — despised and rejected." |
| 6 | <i>And when I passed by thee, and saw thee polluted in thine own blood, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live; yea, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live.</i> | "Then I passed by and saw You there, struggling in Your blood. I said to You as You lay in Your blood, 'Live!' Yes, I said to You in Your blood, 'Live!'" |

- 7 *I have caused thee to multiply as the bud of the field, and thou hast increased and waxen great, and thou art come to excellent ornaments: thy breasts are fashioned, and thine hair is grown, whereas thou wast naked and bare.* "I made You grow like a plant of the field. You grew up and became tall. You came to have great beauty. Your breasts formed and Your hair grew, yet You were naked and bare."
- 8 *Now when I passed by thee, and looked upon thee, behold, thy time was the time of love; and I spread my skirt over thee, and covered thy nakedness: yea, I swear unto thee, and entered into a covenant with thee, saith the Lord GOD, and thou becamest mine.* "Later I passed by and looked at You, and You were old enough for love. I spread the corner of My garment over You and covered Your nakedness. I gave You My solemn oath and entered into a covenant with You, declares the Lord GOD, and You became Mine."
- **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — "a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people." When God entered into a covenant with Jerusalem, He made a permanent, binding commitment — not a casual contract but a sworn oath.
- 9 *Then washed I thee with water; yea, I thoroughly washed away thy blood from thee, and I anointed thee with oil.* "I bathed You with water, washed the blood from You, and anointed You with oil."
- 10 *I clothed thee also with broidered work, and shod thee with badgers' skin, and I girded thee about with fine linen, and I covered thee with silk.* "I dressed You in embroidered cloth and gave You fine leather sandals. I wrapped You in fine linen and covered You with costly fabric."
- 11 *I decked thee also with ornaments, and I put bracelets upon thy hands, and a chain on thy neck.* "I adorned You with jewelry. I put bracelets on Your wrists and a necklace around Your neck."
- 12 *And I put a jewel on thy forehead, and earrings in thine ears, and a beautiful crown upon thine head.* "I put a ring on Your nose, earrings in Your ears, and a beautiful crown on Your head."

- 13 *Thus wast thou decked with gold and silver; and thy raiment was of fine linen, and silk, and brodered work; thou didst eat fine flour, and honey, and oil: and thou wast exceeding beautiful, and thou didst prosper into a kingdom.* "You were adorned with gold and silver. Your clothing was fine linen, costly fabric, and embroidered cloth. You ate fine flour, honey, and olive oil. You grew very beautiful and became a queen."
- 14 *And thy renown went forth among the heathen for thy beauty: for it was perfect through my comeliness, which I had put upon thee, saith the Lord GOD.* "Your fame spread among the heathen because of your beauty, for it was perfect because of the splendor I gave You, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *But thou didst trust in thine own beauty, and playedst the harlot because of thy renown, and pouredst out thy fornications on every one that passed by; his it was.* "But You trusted in Your beauty and used Your fame to become a harlot. You lavished Your favors on everyone who passed by and Your beauty became His."
- 16 *And of thy garments thou didst take, and deckedst thy high places with divers colours, and playedst the harlot thereupon: the like things shall not come, neither shall it be so.* "You took some of Your clothes and made colorful shrines, where You played the harlot. Such things should not happen and should not occur."
- 17 *Thou hast also taken thy fair jewels of my gold and of my silver, which I had given thee, and madest to thyself images of men, and didst commit whoredom with them,* "You also took the beautiful jewelry I gave You — the gold and silver — and You made for Yourself male idols and committed whoredom with them."
- 18 *And tookest thy brodered garments, and coveredst them: and thou hast set mine oil and mine incense before them.* "You took Your embroidered clothes and covered them. You set My oil and My incense before them."

- 19 *My meat also which I gave thee, fine flour, and oil, and honey, wherewith I fed thee, thou hast even set it before them for a sweet savour: and thus it was, saith the Lord GOD.* "Also the food I gave You — the fine flour, olive oil, and honey I fed You — you offered as a fragrant aroma before them. That is what happened, declares the Lord GOD."
- 20 *Moreover thou hast taken thy sons and thy daughters, whom thou hast borne unto me, and these hast thou sacrificed unto them to be devoured. Is this of thy whoredoms a small matter,* "And You took Your sons and daughters whom You bore to Me and sacrificed them as food to idols. Was Your whoredom not enough?"
- 21 *That thou hast slain my children, and delivered them to cause them to pass through the fire for them?* "You slaughtered My children and sacrificed them to the idols."
- 22 *And in all thine abominations and thy whoredoms thou hast not remembered the days of thy youth, when thou wast naked and bare, and wast polluted in thy blood.* "In all Your abominations and Your whoredom You did not remember the days of Your youth — when You were naked and bare, struggling in Your blood."
- 23 *And it came to pass after all thy wickedness, (woe, woe unto thee! saith the Lord GOD;)* "After all Your wickedness — how terrible it will be for You, declares the Lord GOD —"
- 24 *That thou hast also built unto thee an eminent place, and hast made thee an high place in every street.* "you built Yourself a shrine and made Yourself a high place in every public square."
- 25 *Thou hast built thy high place at every head of the way, and hast made thy beauty to be abhorred, and hast opened thy legs to every one that passed by, and multiplied thy whoredoms.* "At every street corner You built Your shrines and degraded Your beauty, offering Yourself to anyone who passed by and multiplying your whoredoms."
- 26 *Thou hast also committed fornication with the Egyptians thy neighbours, great of flesh; and hast increased thy whoredoms, to provoke me to anger.* "You committed fornication with the Egyptians, Your neighbors of great flesh, and multiplied Your whoredoms to provoke Me to anger."

- 27 *Behold, therefore I have stretched out my hand over thee, and have diminished thine ordinary food, and delivered thee unto the will of them that hate thee, the daughters of the Philistines, which are ashamed of thy lewd way.* "Therefore I stretched out My hand against You and reduced Your food supply. I handed You over to the desire of those who hate You — the daughters of the Philistines, who were appalled by Your shameless conduct."
- 28 *Thou hast played the whore also with the Assyrians, because thou wast unsatiable; yea, thou hast played the harlot with them, and yet couldst not be satisfied.* "You also played the harlot with the Assyrians because You were never satisfied. You played the harlot with them and still could not be satisfied."
- 29 *Thou hast moreover multiplied thy fornication in the land of Canaan unto Chaldea; and yet thou wast not satisfied herewith.* "You multiplied Your whoredoms in the land of Canaan all the way to Chaldea, yet even then You were not satisfied."
- 30 *How weak is thine heart, saith the Lord GOD, seeing thou doest all these things, the work of an imperious whorish woman;* "How sick Your heart is, declares the Lord GOD, that You did all these things — the brazen acts of a shameless harlot."
- 31 *In that thou buildest thine eminent place in the head of every way, and makest thine high place in every street; and hast not been as an harlot, in that thou scornest hire;* "When You built Your shrines at every street corner and Your high places in every public square, You were unlike a harlot — you refused payment."
- 32 *But as a wife that committeth adultery, which taketh strangers instead of her husband!* "You were an adulterous wife who takes strangers instead of her own husband!"
- 33 *They give gifts to all whores: but thou givest thy gifts to all thy lovers, and hirest them, that they may come unto thee on every side for thy whoredom.* "Every harlot receives payment, but You gave gifts to all Your lovers, paying them to come to You from all around for Your whoredoms."

- 34 *And the contrary is in thee from other women in thy whoredoms, whereas none followeth thee to commit whoredoms: and in that thou givest a reward, and no reward is given unto thee, therefore thou art contrary.* "You were the opposite of other women. No one solicited you — you solicited them. You paid Your lovers instead of receiving payment. You were completely different."
- 35 *Wherefore, O harlot, hear the word of the LORD:* "Therefore, You harlot, hear the word of the LORD!"
- 36 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thy filthiness was poured out, and thy nakedness discovered through thy whoredoms with thy lovers, and with all the idols of thy abominations, and by the blood of thy children, which thou didst give unto them;* "This is what the Lord GOD says: Because You poured out Your lust and exposed Your nakedness in Your whoredom with Your lovers — with all Your vile idols — and because You gave them Your children's blood —"
- 37 *Behold, therefore I will gather all thy lovers, with whom thou hast taken pleasure, and all them that thou hast loved, with all them that thou hast hated; I will even gather them round about against thee, and will discover thy nakedness unto them, that they may see all thy nakedness.* "therefore I am going to gather all Your lovers with whom You found pleasure — all those You loved and all those You hated. I will gather them against You from all around and strip You naked in front of them, and they will see Your complete nakedness."
- 38 *And I will judge thee, as women that break wedlock and shed blood are judged; and I will give thee blood in fury and jealousy.* "I will punish You as women who commit adultery and shed blood are punished. I will bring on You the blood of wrath and jealousy."
- 39 *And I will also give thee into their hand, and they shall throw down thine eminent place, and shall break down thy high places: they shall strip thee also of thy clothes, and shall take thy fair jewels, and leave thee naked and bare.* "I will hand You over to them, and they will tear down Your shrines and demolish Your high places. They will strip off Your clothes, take Your beautiful jewelry, and leave You naked and bare."

- 40 *They shall also bring up a company against thee, and they shall stone thee with stones, and thrust thee through with their swords.* "They will bring a crowd against You and stone You and cut You to pieces with their swords."
- 41 *And they shall burn thine houses with fire, and execute judgments upon thee in the sight of many women: and I will cause thee to cease from playing the harlot, and thou also shalt give no hire any more.* "They will burn Your houses with fire and execute judgment on You in the sight of many women. I will put an end to Your whoredom, and You will no longer pay lovers."
- 42 *So will I make my fury toward thee to rest, and my jealousy shall depart from thee, and I will be quiet, and will be no more angry.* "Then My wrath against You will be spent and My jealousy will depart. I will be calm and no longer angry."
- 43 *Because thou hast not remembered the days of thy youth, but hast fretted me in all these things; behold, therefore I also will recompense thy way upon thine head, saith the Lord GOD: and thou shalt not commit this lewdness above all thine abominations.* "Because You did not remember the days of Your youth but enraged Me with all these things — I will surely bring Your conduct down on Your own head, declares the Lord GOD. Did You not add indecency to all Your other abominations?"
- 44 *Behold, every one that useth proverbs shall use this proverb against thee, saying, As is the mother, so is her daughter.* "Everyone who uses proverbs will apply this to You: 'Like mother, like daughter.'"
- 45 *Thou art thy mother's daughter, that lotheth her husband and her children; and thou art the sister of thy sisters, which lothed their husbands and their children: your mother was an Hittite, and your father an Amorite.* "You are a true daughter of Your mother, who despised her husband and her children. You are a true sister of Your sisters, who despised their husbands and children. Your mother was a Hittite and Your father an Amorite."

- 46 *And thine elder sister is Samaria, she and her daughters that dwell at thy left hand: and thy younger sister, that dwelleth at thy right hand, is Sodom and her daughters.* "Your older sister is Samaria, who lives with her daughters to Your north. Your younger sister, who lives with her daughters to Your south, is Sodom."
- 47 *Yet hast thou not walked after their ways, nor done after their abominations: but, as if that were a very little thing, thou wast corrupted more than they in all thy ways.* "You have not merely walked in their ways or done their abominations. In a very short time You were more corrupt than they in all Your ways."
- 48 *As I live, saith the Lord GOD, Sodom thy sister hath not done, she nor her daughters, as thou hast done, thou and thy daughters.* "As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, Your sister Sodom and her daughters never did what You and Your daughters have done."
- 49 *Behold, this was the iniquity of thy sister Sodom, pride, fulness of bread, and abundance of idleness was in her and in her daughters, neither did she strengthen the hand of the poor and needy.* "Now this was the iniquity of Your sister Sodom: she and her daughters had pride, fullness of bread, and abundance of idleness. They did not strengthen the hand of the poor and needy."
- 50 *And they were haughty, and committed abomination before me: therefore I took them away as I saw good.* "They were haughty and did detestable things before Me. Therefore I removed them when I saw it."
- 51 *Neither hath Samaria committed half of thy sins; but thou hast multiplied thine abominations more than they, and hast justified thy sisters in all thine abominations which thou hast done.* "Samaria did not commit half Your sins. You have done more abominations than they have. By all the abominations You have done, You have made Your sisters look righteous."

- 52 *Thou also, which hast judged thy sisters, bear thine own shame for thy sins that thou hast committed more abominable than they: they are more righteous than thou: yea, be thou confounded also, and bear thy shame, in that thou hast justified thy sisters.* "Bear Your own disgrace, for You have given Your sisters reason to appear righteous. Since You sinned more abominably than they did, they are more righteous than You. Be ashamed and bear Your disgrace, for You have made Your sisters appear righteous."
- 53 *When I shall bring again their captivity, the captivity of Sodom and her daughters, and the captivity of Samaria and her daughters, then will I bring again the captivity of thy captives in the midst of them:* "But I will bring again their captivity — the captivity of Sodom and her daughters, and the captivity of Samaria and her daughters — and I will bring again Your captives in the midst of them."
- 54 *That thou mayest bear thine own shame, and mayest be confounded in all that thou hast done, in that thou art a comfort unto them.* "so that You may bear Your disgrace and be ashamed of all You have done in becoming a comfort to them."
- 55 *When thy sisters, Sodom and her daughters, shall return to their former estate, and Samaria and her daughters shall return to their former estate, then thou and thy daughters shall return to your former estate.* "Your sisters — Sodom and her daughters, and Samaria and her daughters — will return to what they were before. You and Your daughters will also return to what You were before."
- 56 *For thy sister Sodom was not mentioned by thy mouth in the day of thy pride,* "In Your days of pride You did not even mention Your sister Sodom."
- 57 *Before thy wickedness was discovered, as at the time of thy reproach of the daughters of Syria, and all that are round about her, the daughters of the Philistines, which despise thee round about.* "That was before Your wickedness was exposed. Now You are the object of scorn for the daughters of Aram and all her neighbors, and for the daughters of the Philistines — all those around You who despise You."

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| 58 | <i>Thou hast borne thy lewdness and thine abominations, saith the LORD.</i> | "You will bear the consequences of Your lewdness and Your abominations, declares the LORD." |
| 59 | <i>For thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even deal with thee as thou hast done, which hast despised the oath in breaking the covenant.</i> | "For this is what the Lord GOD says: I will deal with You as You deserve, because You have despised the oath by breaking the covenant." |
| 60 | <i>Nevertheless I will remember my covenant with thee in the days of thy youth, and I will establish unto thee an everlasting covenant.</i> | "Yet I will remember the covenant I made with You in the days of Your youth, and I will establish an everlasting covenant with You." |
| 61 | <i>Then thou shalt remember thy ways, and be ashamed, when thou shalt receive thy sisters, thine elder and thy younger: and I will give them unto thee for daughters, but not by thy covenant.</i> | "Then You will remember Your ways and be ashamed when You receive Your sisters, both Your older and Your younger. I will give them to You as daughters, but not on account of Your covenant." |
| 62 | <i>And I will establish my covenant with thee; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD:</i> | "So I will establish My covenant with You, and You will know that I am the LORD." |
| 63 | <i>That thou mayest remember, and be confounded, and never open thy mouth any more because of thy shame, when I am pacified toward thee for all that thou hast done, saith the Lord GOD.</i> | "Then when I make atonement for You for all You have done, You will remember and be ashamed and never open Your mouth again because of Your disgrace, declares the Lord GOD." |

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Philistines (*FIL-ih-steen-z*) — Israel's most persistent enemies in the era of the judges and early monarchy — a sea-faring people from the Aegean who settled along Canaan's coast;

gave their name to 'Palestine.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v3 — Ezek 16:45; Isa 51:1-2; Deut 20:17; John 8:44; Neh 9:7

v6 — Eph 2:4-5; John 5:25; Titus 3:3-7; Acts 7:34; Matt 5:13

v7 — Deut 1:10; Ex 1:7; Isa 62:3

v8 — Jer 2:2-3; Ruth 3:9; Rom 5:8; Isa 43:4; Ex 32:13

v9 — Ruth 3:3; Ps 23:5

v10 — Ezek 16:18; Ezek 16:13

v11 — Gen 24:22; Isa 3:19; Gen 41:42; Gen 24:47; Prov 1:9

v13 — Ps 50:2; Deut 32:13-14; 1 Kgs 4:21

v14 — Lam 2:15; 1 Kgs 10:24

v15 — Ezek 16:25; Jer 2:20; Isa 57:8

v49 — Ezek 28:2; Ps 138:6; Gen 13:10; Luke 12:16-20

v63 — Rom 3:19; Ps 39:9; Job 40:4-5; Dan 9:7-8; Ezek 36:31-32

Chapter 17

Ezekiel tells a riddle of two great eagles and a vine. The first eagle represents Babylon, which planted Zedekiah as a vassal king; but the vine turned toward a second eagle — Egypt — breaking the covenant. The LORD declares that He Himself will plant a tender twig on a high mountain, and it will become a noble cedar.

- 1 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 *Son of man, put forth a riddle, and speak a parable unto the house of Israel;* "Son of man, set forth a riddle and tell a parable to the house of Israel."

- 3 *And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; A great eagle with great wings, longwinged, full of feathers, which had divers colours, came unto Lebanon, and took the highest branch of the cedar:* "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: A great eagle with powerful wings, long feathers, and full plumage of varied colors came to Lebanon and took the top of the cedar."
- 4 *He cropped off the top of his young twigs, and carried it into a land of traffick; he set it in a city of merchants.* "He broke off the topmost of its young twigs and carried it to a land of traders. He planted it in a city of merchants."
- 5 *He took also of the seed of the land, and planted it in a fruitful field; he placed it by great waters, and set it as a willow tree.* "He also took some of the seed of the land and planted it in fertile soil. He put it beside plentiful waters and set it like a willow."
- 6 *And it grew, and became a spreading vine of low stature, whose branches turned toward him, and the roots thereof were under him: so it became a vine, and brought forth branches, and shot forth sprigs.* "It sprouted and became a spreading vine — low-growing but wide. Its branches turned toward Him, and its roots grew down into the soil. So it became a vine, produced branches, and put out leafy boughs."
- 7 *There was also another great eagle with great wings and many feathers: and, behold, this vine did bend her roots toward him, and shot forth her branches toward him, that he might water it by the furrows of her plantation.* "But there was another great eagle with powerful wings and full plumage. This vine bent its roots toward Him and stretched its branches toward Him, looking for water from the soil where it was planted."
- 8 *It was planted in a good soil by great waters, that it might bring forth branches, and that it might bear fruit, that it might be a goodly vine.* "It had been planted in good soil beside abundant waters so it could produce branches, bear fruit, and become a splendid vine."

- 9 *Say thou, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Shall it prosper? shall he not pull up the roots thereof, and cut off the fruit thereof, that it wither? it shall wither in all the leaves of its spring, even without great power or many people to pluck it up by the roots thereof.* "Say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: Will it thrive? Will not the first eagle pull up its roots and strip off its fruit so it withers? All its fresh growth will wither. It will not take a strong arm or many people to pull it up by the roots."
- 10 *Yea, behold, being planted, shall it prosper? shall it not utterly wither, when the east wind toucheth it? it shall wither in the furrows where it grew.* "Even though it was planted, will it thrive? Will it not utterly wither when the east wind strikes it — wither away in the very beds where it grew?"
- 11 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 12 *Say now to the rebellious house, Know ye not what these things mean? tell them, Behold, the king of Babylon is come to Jerusalem, and hath taken the king thereof, and the princes thereof, and led them with him to Babylon;* "Say to that rebellious house: Don't you know what these things mean? The king of Babylon came to Jerusalem, took its king and its officials, and brought them back to Babylon."
- 13 *And hath taken of the king's seed, and made a covenant with him, and hath taken an oath of him: he hath also taken the mighty of the land:* "He took a member of the royal family and made a covenant with him, binding him with an oath. He also took away the leading men of the land."
- 14 *That the kingdom might be base, that it might not lift itself up, but that by keeping of his covenant it might stand.* "This was so that the kingdom would be kept low, unable to rise again — surviving only by keeping the covenant."

- 15 *But he rebelled against him in sending his ambassadors into Egypt, that they might give him horses and much people. Shall he prosper? shall he escape that doeth such things? or shall he break the covenant, and be delivered?* "But the king of Judah rebelled against Babylon by sending envoys to Egypt to get horses and a great army. Will he succeed? Can he break the covenant and escape?"
- 16 *As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely in the place where the king dwelleth that made him king, whose oath he despised, and whose covenant he brake, even with him in the midst of Babylon he shall die.* "As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, He will die in Babylon — in the land of the king who put him on the throne and whose oath he despised and whose covenant He broke."
- 17 *Neither shall Pharaoh with his mighty army and great company make for him in the war, by casting up mounts, and building forts, to cut off many persons:* "Pharaoh with his mighty army and great forces will not help him in the war when siege ramps are built and siege towers erected to destroy many lives."
- 18 *Seeing he despised the oath by breaking the covenant, when, lo, he had given his hand, and hath done all these things, he shall not escape.* "He despised the oath by breaking the covenant. Because he had given his word and done all these things, he will not escape."
- 19 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; As I live, surely mine oath that he hath despised, and my covenant that he hath broken, even it will I recompense upon his own head.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: As surely as I live, I will bring down on His own head the oath He despised and the covenant He broke."
- 20 *And I will spread my net upon him, and he shall be taken in my snare, and I will bring him to Babylon, and will plead with him there for his trespass that he hath trespassed against me.* "I will throw My net over Him and catch Him in My snare. I will bring Him to Babylon and enter into judgment with Him there for the trespass He committed against Me."

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| <p>21 <i>And all his fugitives with all his bands shall fall by the sword, and they that remain shall be scattered toward all winds: and ye shall know that I the LORD have spoken it.</i></p> | <p>"All His best troops will fall by the sword, and the survivors will be scattered in every direction. You will know that I the LORD have spoken."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also take of the highest branch of the high cedar, and will set it; I will crop off from the top of his young twigs a tender one, and will plant it upon an high mountain and eminent:</i></p> | <p>"This is what the Lord GOD says: I Myself will take a tender shoot from the top of a tall cedar and plant it. From the topmost of its young branches I will take a tender sprig and plant it on a high and lofty mountain."</p> |
| <p>23 <i>In the mountain of the height of Israel will I plant it: and it shall bring forth boughs, and bear fruit, and be a goodly cedar: and under it shall dwell all fowl of every wing; in the shadow of the branches thereof shall they dwell.</i></p> | <p>"On the mountain heights of Israel I will plant it. It will produce branches and bear fruit and become a great cedar. Birds of every kind will nest in it. They will find shelter in the shade of its branches."</p> |
| <p>24 <i>And all the trees of the field shall know that I the LORD have brought down the high tree, have exalted the low tree, have dried up the green tree, and have made the dry tree to flourish: I the LORD have spoken and have done it.</i></p> | <p>"All the trees of the field will know that I the LORD bring down the tall tree and make the low tree grow tall. I dry up the green tree and make the dry tree flourish. I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it."</p> |

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ezek 20:49
- v5 — Isa 44:4; Deut 8:7-9
- v10 — Hos 13:15
- v13 — 2 Chr 36:13
- v16 — Ezek 12:13
- v17 — Jer 37:7

v20 — Ezek 12:13

v23 — Matt 13:32; Ezek 31:6; Isa 2:2

v24 — Amos 9:11; 1 Cor 1:27-28

Chapter 18

The LORD declares that the soul that sins shall die — each person bears their own iniquity. A righteous man who turns to wickedness will die; a wicked man who repents and does what is right will live. The LORD takes no pleasure in the death of the wicked but calls all to repent and live.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD came unto me again, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>What mean ye, that ye use this proverb concerning the land of Israel, saying, The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge?</i> | "What do You mean by using this proverb in the land of Israel: 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge'?" |
| 3 | <i>As I live, saith the Lord GOD, ye shall not have occasion any more to use this proverb in Israel.</i> | "As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, You will no longer use this proverb in Israel." |
| 4 | <i>Behold, all souls are mine; as the soul of the father, so also the soul of the son is mine: the soul that sinneth, it shall die.</i> | "Every soul belongs to Me — the soul of the father and the soul of the son alike. The soul that sins is the one who will die." |
| 5 | <i>But if a man be just, and do that which is lawful and right,</i> | "Suppose a man is righteous and does what is just and right." |
| 6 | <i>And hath not eaten upon the mountains, neither hath lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, neither hath defiled his neighbour's wife, neither hath come near to a menstruous woman,</i> | "He does not eat at the mountain shrines or look to the idols of Israel. He does not defile His neighbor's wife or sleep with a woman during her period." |
| 7 | <i>And hath not oppressed any, but hath restored to the debtor his pledge, hath spoiled none by violence, hath given his bread to the hungry, and hath covered the naked with a garment;</i> | "He does not oppress anyone but returns what a borrower pledged. He does not commit robbery but gives His food to the hungry and provides clothing for the naked." |

- 8 *He that hath not given forth upon usury, neither hath taken any increase, that hath withdrawn his hand from iniquity, hath executed true judgment between man and man,* "He does not lend money at interest or take a profit. He keeps His hand from wrongdoing and judges fairly between man and man."
- 9 *Hath walked in my statutes, and hath kept my judgments, to deal truly; he is just, he shall surely live, saith the Lord GOD.* "He follows My decrees and keeps My laws faithfully. That man is righteous. He will surely live, declares the Lord GOD."
- 10 *If he beget a son that is a robber, a shedder of blood, and that doeth the like to any one of these things,* "But suppose this man has a violent son who sheds blood and does any of these things —"
- 11 *And that doeth not any of those duties, but even hath eaten upon the mountains, and defiled his neighbour's wife,* "though the father did not do any of them. The son eats at the mountain shrines, defiles his neighbor's wife,"
- 12 *Hath oppressed the poor and needy, hath spoiled by violence, hath not restored the pledge, and hath lifted up his eyes to the idols, hath committed abomination,* "oppresses the poor and needy, commits robbery, does not return what he took as a pledge, looks to idols, and does detestable things."
- 13 *Hath given forth upon usury, and hath taken increase: shall he then live? he shall not live: he hath done all these abominations; he shall surely die; his blood shall be upon him.* "He lends at interest and takes a profit. Will such a man live? He will not! Because he has done all these detestable things, he will surely die. His blood will be on his own head."
- 14 *Now, lo, if he beget a son, that seeth all his father's sins which he hath done, and considereth, and doeth not such like,* "But suppose this violent son has a son who sees all the sins his father committed, and though he sees them, he does not do such things."
- 15 *That hath not eaten upon the mountains, neither hath lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, hath not defiled his neighbour's wife,* "He does not eat at the mountain shrines or look to the idols of Israel. He does not defile his neighbor's wife."

- 16 *Neither hath oppressed any, hath not withholden the pledge, neither hath spoiled by violence, but hath given his bread to the hungry, and hath covered the naked with a garment,* "He does not oppress anyone or hold back any pledge. He does not commit robbery but gives his food to the hungry and provides clothing for the naked."
- 17 *That hath taken off his hand from the poor, that hath not received usury nor increase, hath executed my judgments, hath walked in my statutes; he shall not die for the iniquity of his father, he shall surely live.* "He withholds his hand from sin and takes no interest or profit. He keeps My laws and follows My decrees. He will not die for his father's iniquity. He will surely live."
- 18 *As for his father, because he cruelly oppressed, spoiled his brother by violence, and did that which is not good among his people, behold, even he shall die in his iniquity.* "But his father will die for his own iniquity, because he practiced extortion, robbed his brother, and did what was wrong among his people."
- 19 *Yet say ye, Why? doth not the son bear the iniquity of the father? When the son hath done that which is lawful and right, and hath kept all my statutes, and hath done them, he shall surely live.* "Yet you say, 'Why? Does not the son bear the iniquity of the father?' When the son has done what is lawful and right, and has kept all My statutes and done them, he will surely live."
- 20 *The soul that sinneth, it shall die. The son shall not bear the iniquity of the father, neither shall the father bear the iniquity of the son: the righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon him.* "The soul that sins, it shall die. The son shall not bear the iniquity of the father, neither shall the father bear the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon him."
- 21 *But if the wicked will turn from all his sins that he hath committed, and keep all my statutes, and do that which is lawful and right, he shall surely live, he shall not die.* "But if a wicked person turns away from all his sins and keeps all My decrees, doing what is just and right — he will surely live. He will not die."

- 22 *All his transgressions that he hath committed, they shall not be mentioned unto him: in his righteousness that he hath done he shall live.* "None of the offenses he has committed will be counted against him. Because of the righteous things he has done, he will live."
- 23 *Have I any pleasure at all that the wicked should die? saith the Lord GOD: and not that he should return from his ways, and live?* "Do I take any pleasure in the death of the wicked? declares the Lord GOD. Rather, am I not pleased when they turn from their ways and live?"
- 24 *But when the righteous turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and doeth according to all the abominations that the wicked man doeth, shall he live? All his righteousness that he hath done shall not be mentioned: in his trespass that he hath trespassed, and in his sin that he hath sinned, in them shall he die.* "But if a righteous person turns from their righteousness and commits iniquity, doing all the abominations the wicked person does, will they live? None of the righteous things they have done will be remembered. In their trespass that they have trespassed and in their sin that they have sinned, they will die."
- 25 *Yet ye say, The way of the LORD is not equal. Hear now, O house of Israel; Is not my way equal? are not your ways unequal?* "Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' Hear me, house of Israel: Is My way unfair? Is it not your ways that are unfair?"
- 26 *When a righteous man turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and dieth in them; for his iniquity that he hath done shall he die.* "If a righteous person turns from their righteousness and commits sin, they die for it. They die because of the sin they have committed."
- 27 *Again, when the wicked man turneth away from his wickedness that he hath committed, and doeth that which is lawful and right, he shall save his soul alive.* "But if a wicked person turns away from the wickedness they have committed and does what is just and right, they will save their life."

- 28 *Because he considereth, and turneth away from all his transgressions that he hath committed, he shall surely live, he shall not die.* "Because they considered all the offenses they had committed and turned away from them, they will surely live. They will not die."
- 29 *Yet saith the house of Israel, The way of the Lord is not equal. O house of Israel, are not my ways equal? are not your ways unequal?* "Yet the house of Israel says, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' Are My ways unfair, house of Israel? Is it not your ways that are unfair?"
- 30 *Therefore I will judge you, O house of Israel, every one according to his ways, saith the Lord GOD. Repent, and turn yourselves from all your transgressions; so iniquity shall not be your ruin.* "Therefore I will judge You, house of Israel, each one according to his own ways, declares the Lord GOD. Repent! Turn away from all Your offenses. Then iniquity will not be Your downfall."
- 31 *Cast away from you all your transgressions, whereby ye have transgressed; and make you a new heart and a new spirit: for why will ye die, O house of Israel?* "Rid yourselves of all the offenses You have committed, and get a new heart and a new spirit. Why will You die, house of Israel?"
- 32 *For I have no pleasure in the death of him that dieth, saith the Lord GOD: wherefore turn yourselves, and live ye.* "For I take no pleasure in the death of anyone, declares the Lord GOD. Repent and live!"

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

v2 — Lam 5:7; Jer 31:29-30; Ezek 37:19; Ezek 37:11; Ezek 37:25

v4 — Ezek 18:20; Rom 6:23; Num 16:22; Heb 12:9; Gal 3:10-13

v7 — Ezek 18:16; Ezek 18:12; Ex 22:26; Deut 24:12-13

v9 — Ezek 20:11; Hab 2:4; Amos 5:4

v20 — 2 Kgs 14:6; Deut 24:16; Ezek 18:4; Jer 31:29-30; Matt 16:27

v21 — Ezek 33:19; Ezek 18:27-28; Titus 2:11-14; Ezek 18:9; Rom 8:13

- v23 — Ezek 33:11; 1 Tim 2:4; 2 Pet 3:9; Ezek 18:32; Luke 15:32
 v24 — Ezek 33:18; Prov 21:16; 2 John 1:8; Ezek 33:12-13; Gal 3:4
 v27 — Ezek 18:21; Isa 1:18; Isa 55:7
 v30 — Ezek 18:21; Matt 16:27; Matt 3:2; Luke 13:3; Ezek 14:6
 v31 — Ps 51:10; Ezek 36:26; Rom 8:13; Ezek 11:19; Isa 1:16-17
 v32 — 2 Pet 3:9; Ezek 18:23; Ezek 33:11; Lam 3:33

Chapter 19

Ezekiel takes up a lament for the princes of Israel. Their mother is pictured as a lioness whose cubs were captured — one taken to Egypt, the other to Babylon. She is then compared to a vine once fruitful and strong, now plucked up, withered, and burned with fire.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover take thou up a lamentation for the princes of Israel,</i> | <i>"Take up a lament for the princes of Israel."</i> |
| 2 | <i>And say, What is thy mother? A lioness: she lay down among lions, she nourished her whelps among young lions.</i> | <i>"Say: What was your mother? A lioness among lions. She crouched down among young lions. She reared her cubs."</i> |
| 3 | <i>And she brought up one of her whelps: it became a young lion, and it learned to catch the prey; it devoured men.</i> | <i>"She brought up one of her cubs. He became a young lion. He learned to prey on animals. He devoured men."</i> |
| 4 | <i>The nations also heard of him; he was taken in their pit, and they brought him with chains unto the land of Egypt.</i> | <i>"The nations heard about him. He was caught in their pit. They led him away with hooks to the land of Egypt."</i> |
| 5 | <i>Now when she saw that she had waited, and her hope was lost, then she took another of her whelps, and made him a young lion.</i> | <i>"When she saw that her hope was gone — her expectation had failed — she took another of her cubs and made him a young lion."</i> |
| 6 | <i>And he went up and down among the lions, he became a young lion, and learned to catch the prey, and devoured men.</i> | <i>"He prowled among the lions. He became a young lion. He learned to prey on animals. He devoured men."</i> |

- 7 *And he knew their desolate palaces, and he laid waste their cities; and the land was desolate, and the fulness thereof, by the noise of his roaring.* "He broke down their strongholds and devastated their towns. The land and everything in it was terrified by the sound of his roaring."
- 8 *Then the nations set against him on every side from the provinces, and spread their net over him: he was taken in their pit.* "Then the nations came against him from the surrounding regions. They spread their net over him and caught him in their pit."
- 9 *And they put him in ward in chains, and brought him to the king of Babylon: they brought him into holds, that his voice should no more be heard upon the mountains of Israel.* "With hooks they put him in a cage and brought him to the king of Babylon. They put him in prison so his roar would no longer be heard on the mountains of Israel."
- 10 *Thy mother is like a vine in thy blood, planted by the waters: she was fruitful and full of branches by reason of many waters.* "Your mother was like a vine in your vineyard, planted beside the water. It was fruitful and full of branches because of the abundant water."
- 11 *And she had strong rods for the sceptres of them that bare rule, and her stature was exalted among the thick branches, and she appeared in her height with the multitude of her branches.* "Its branches were strong — fit to be a ruler's scepter. It grew tall and reached up to the clouds. It was conspicuous for its height and its many branches."
- 12 *But she was plucked up in fury, she was cast down to the ground, and the east wind dried up her fruit: her strong rods were broken and withered; the fire consumed them.* "But it was uprooted in fury and thrown down to the ground. The east wind dried up its fruit. Its strong branches were torn off and withered. Fire consumed them."
- 13 *And now she is planted in the wilderness, in a dry and thirsty ground.* "Now it is planted in the desert, in a dry and thirsty land."

- 14 *And fire is gone out of a rod of her branches, which hath devoured her fruit, so that she hath no strong rod to be a sceptre to rule. This is a lamentation, and shall be for a lamentation.* "Fire spread from one of its main branches and consumed its fruit. No strong branch is left on it fit to be a ruler's scepter. This is a lament, and it is used as a lament."

Words in this chapter:

lamentation (*lam-en-TAY-shun*) — a funeral song of grief; this chapter is a lament over the princes of Israel

sceptre (*SEP-tur*) — a rod of authority held by a ruler; symbolizes royal power

Cross-References:

v10 — Ps 80:8-11

v12 — Hos 13:15; Ezek 17:10

v13 — Hos 2:3

Chapter 20

Elders come to inquire of the LORD, but He refuses them and recounts Israel's long history of rebellion — in Egypt, in the wilderness, and in the land. Yet for the sake of His name, He will gather them from the nations, purge the rebels, and bring them to the mountain of Israel where they will serve Him.

- 1 *And it came to pass in the seventh year, in the fifth month, the tenth day of the month, that certain of the elders of Israel came to enquire of the LORD, and sat before me.* In the seventh year, on the tenth day of the fifth month, some of the elders of Israel came to inquire of the LORD. They sat down in front of me.
- 2 *Then came the word of the LORD unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 3 *Son of man, speak unto the elders of Israel, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Are ye come to enquire of me? As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will not be enquired of by you.* "Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel and say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: Have You come to inquire of Me? As surely as I live, I will not let You inquire of Me, declares the Lord GOD."

- 4 *Wilt thou judge them, son of man, wilt thou judge them? cause them to know the abominations of their fathers:* "Will You judge them? Will You judge them, Son of man? Confront them with the abominations of their fathers."
- 5 *And say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day when I chose Israel, and lifted up mine hand unto the seed of the house of Jacob, and made myself known unto them in the land of Egypt, when I lifted up mine hand unto them, saying, I am the LORD your God;* "Say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: On the day I chose Israel and raised My hand in oath to the descendants of the house of Jacob, I made Myself known to them in Egypt. I raised My hand to them and said, 'I am the LORD Your God.'"
- 6 *In the day that I lifted up mine hand unto them, to bring them forth of the land of Egypt into a land that I had espied for them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands:* "On that day I swore to bring them out of Egypt into a land I had searched out for them — a land flowing with milk and honey, the most beautiful of all lands."
- 7 *Then said I unto them, Cast ye away every man the abominations of his eyes, and defile not yourselves with the idols of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.* "I said to them: Each of You — throw away the vile things You set Your eyes on. Do not defile yourselves with the idols of Egypt. I am the LORD Your God."
- 8 *But they rebelled against me, and would not hearken unto me: they did not every man cast away the abominations of their eyes, neither did they forsake the idols of Egypt: then I said, I will pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them in the midst of the land of Egypt.* "But they rebelled against Me and would not listen. They did not throw away the vile things they had set their eyes on, nor did they forsake the idols of Egypt. So I said I would pour out My wrath on them and accomplish My anger against them in Egypt."
- 9 *But I wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted before the heathen, among whom they were, in whose sight I made myself known unto them, to bring them forth out of the land of Egypt.* "But I acted for the sake of My name, that it would not be profaned in the eyes of the heathen among whom they lived. In their sight I made Myself known to Israel by bringing them out of Egypt."

- 10 *Wherefore I caused them to go forth out of the land of Egypt, and brought them into the wilderness.* "So I brought them out of Egypt and led them into the desert."
- 11 *And I gave them my statutes, and shewed them my judgments, which if a man do, he shall even live in them.* "I gave them My decrees and laws. The man who obeys them will live by them."
- 12 *Moreover also I gave them my sabbaths, to be a sign between me and them, that they might know that I am the LORD that sanctify them.* "I also gave them My Sabbaths as a sign between Me and them, so they would know that I am the LORD Who makes them holy."
- 13 *But the house of Israel rebelled against me in the wilderness: they walked not in my statutes, and they despised my judgments, which if a man do, he shall even live in them; and my sabbaths they greatly polluted: then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them in the wilderness, to consume them.* "But the house of Israel rebelled against Me in the desert. They did not follow My decrees but rejected My laws — though the man who obeys them will live by them — and they greatly desecrated My Sabbaths. So I said I would pour out My wrath on them in the desert and destroy them."
- 14 *But I wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted before the heathen, in whose sight I brought them out.* "But I acted for the sake of My name, that it would not be profaned in the eyes of the heathen who had seen Me bring them out."
- 15 *Yet also I lifted up my hand unto them in the wilderness, that I would not bring them into the land which I had given them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands;* "Also, I swore to them in the desert that I would not bring them into the land I had given them — the land flowing with milk and honey, most beautiful of all lands —"
- 16 *Because they despised my judgments, and walked not in my statutes, but polluted my sabbaths: for their heart went after their idols.* "because they rejected My laws, did not follow My decrees, and desecrated My Sabbaths. Their hearts were devoted to their idols."

- 17 *Nevertheless mine eye spared them from destroying them, neither did I make an end of them in the wilderness.* "Yet I looked on them with pity. I did not destroy them or put an end to them in the desert."
- 18 *But I said unto their children in the wilderness, Walk ye not in the statutes of your fathers, neither observe their judgments, nor defile yourselves with their idols:* "I said to their children in the desert: Do not follow your fathers' decrees or keep their laws or defile yourselves with their idols."
- 19 *I am the LORD your God; walk in my statutes, and keep my judgments, and do them;* "I am the LORD Your God. Follow My decrees and keep My laws and carry them out."
- 20 *And hallow my sabbaths; and they shall be a sign between me and you, that ye may know that I am the LORD your God.* "Keep My Sabbaths holy. They will be a sign between Me and You so You may know that I am the LORD Your God."
- 21 *Notwithstanding the children rebelled against me: they walked not in my statutes, neither kept my judgments to do them, which if a man do, he shall even live in them; they polluted my sabbaths: then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them in the wilderness.* "But the children rebelled against Me too. They did not follow My decrees or keep My laws — though the man who obeys them will live by them — and they desecrated My Sabbaths. So I said I would pour out My wrath on them in the desert and accomplish My anger against them."
- 22 *Nevertheless I withdrew mine hand, and wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted in the sight of the heathen, in whose sight I brought them forth.* "But I held back My hand. I acted for the sake of My name, that it would not be profaned in the eyes of the heathen who had seen Me bring them out."
- 23 *I lifted up mine hand unto them also in the wilderness, that I would scatter them among the heathen, and disperse them through the countries;* "Also, in the desert I swore to scatter them among the heathen and disperse them through the lands."

- 24 *Because they had not executed my judgments, but had despised my statutes, and had polluted my sabbaths, and their eyes were after their fathers' idols.* "This was because they had not obeyed My laws but had rejected My decrees and desecrated My Sabbaths, and their eyes had followed after their fathers' idols."
- 25 *Wherefore I gave them also statutes that were not good, and judgments whereby they should not live;* "So I gave them over to statutes that were not good and laws through which they could not live."
- 26 *And I polluted them in their own gifts, in that they caused to pass through the fire all that openeth the womb, that I might make them desolate, to the end that they might know that I am the LORD.* "I let them become defiled through their gifts — sacrificing every firstborn — so that I could fill them with horror. Then they would know that I am the LORD."
- 27 *Therefore, son of man, speak unto the house of Israel, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Yet in this your fathers have blasphemed me, in that they have committed a trespass against me.* "Therefore, Son of man, speak to the house of Israel and say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: In this also Your fathers blasphemed Me, in that they committed a trespass against Me."
- 28 *For when I had brought them into the land, for the which I lifted up mine hand to give it to them, then they saw every high hill, and all the thick trees, and they offered there their sacrifices, and there they presented the provocation of their offering: there also they made their sweet savour, and poured out there their drink offerings.* "When I brought them into the land I had sworn to give them and they saw any high hill or any leafy tree, they offered their sacrifices there. They brought their offerings that provoked Me. They placed their fragrant incense there and poured out their drink offerings."
- 29 *Then I said unto them, What is the high place whereunto ye go? And the name thereof is called Bamah unto this day.* "Then I said to them: What is this high place You go to? It is called Bamah to this day."

- 30 *Wherefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Are ye polluted after the manner of your fathers? and commit ye whoredom after their abominations?* "Therefore say to the house of Israel: This is what the Lord GOD says: Will You defile yourselves the way Your ancestors did and lust after their vile images?"
- 31 *For when ye offer your gifts, when ye make your sons to pass through the fire, ye pollute yourselves with all your idols, even unto this day: and shall I be enquired of by you, O house of Israel? As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will not be enquired of by you.* "When You offer Your gifts — when You sacrifice Your children in the fire — you continue to defile yourselves with all Your idols to this day. And should I let You inquire of Me, house of Israel? As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will not let You inquire of Me."
- 32 *And that which cometh into your mind shall not be at all, that ye say, We will be as the heathen, as the families of the countries, to serve wood and stone.* "What You have in mind will never happen — your thought that You will be like the heathen, like the peoples of the other lands, serving wood and stone."
- 33 *As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with fury poured out, will I rule over you:* "As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will rule over You with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm and with outpoured wrath."
- 34 *And I will bring you out from the people, and will gather you out of the countries wherein ye are scattered, with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with fury poured out.* "I will bring You out from the nations and gather you from the countries where You have been scattered — with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm and with outpoured wrath."
- 35 *And I will bring you into the wilderness of the people, and there will I plead with you face to face.* "I will bring You into the wilderness of the nations and there I will execute judgment on you face to face."
- 36 *Like as I pleaded with your fathers in the wilderness of the land of Egypt, so will I plead with you, saith the Lord GOD.* "As I judged Your ancestors in the wilderness of Egypt, so I will judge You, declares the Lord GOD."

- 37 *And I will cause you to pass under the rod, and I will bring you into the bond of the covenant:* "I will take note of You as You pass under My rod, and I will bring You into the bond of the covenant."
- 38 *And I will purge out from among you the rebels, and them that transgress against me: I will bring them forth out of the country where they sojourn, and they shall not enter into the land of Israel: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will purge You of those who rebel and transgress against Me. I will bring them out of the land where they are living as strangers, but they will not enter the land of Israel. Then You will know that I am the LORD."
- 39 *As for you, O house of Israel, thus saith the Lord GOD; Go ye, serve ye every one his idols, and hereafter also, if ye will not hearken unto me: but pollute ye my holy name no more with your gifts and with your idols.* "As for You, house of Israel, this is what the Lord GOD says: Go and serve Your idols, every one of you! But afterward you will surely listen to Me and no longer profane My holy name with Your gifts and Your idols."
- 40 *For in mine holy mountain, in the mountain of the height of Israel, saith the Lord GOD, there shall all the house of Israel, all of them in the land, serve me: there will I accept them, and there will I require your offerings, and the firstfruits of your oblations, with all your holy things.* "For on My holy mountain — the high mountain of Israel — the whole house of Israel will serve Me in the land, declares the Lord GOD. There I will accept them. There I will require Your offerings and Your choice gifts, along with all Your holy things."
- 41 *I will accept you with your sweet savour, when I bring you out from the people, and gather you out of the countries wherein ye have been scattered; and I will be sanctified in you before the heathen.* "I will accept You as a fragrant offering when I bring You out from the heathen and gather you from the lands where you have been scattered. I will be proved holy through You in the sight of the heathen."
- 42 *And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall bring you into the land of Israel, into the country for the which I lifted up mine hand to give it to your fathers.* "You will know that I am the LORD when I bring You into the land of Israel — the land I swore to give Your ancestors."

- 43 *And there shall ye remember your ways, and all your doings, wherein ye have been defiled; and ye shall lothe yourselves in your own sight for all your evils that ye have committed.* "There You will remember Your conduct and all the actions by which You have defiled yourselves. You will despise yourselves for all the evil You have done."
- 44 *And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I have wrought with you for my name's sake, not according to your wicked ways, nor according to your corrupt doings, O ye house of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.* "You will know that I am the LORD when I deal with You for My name's sake and not according to Your evil ways and Your corrupt practices, house of Israel, declares the Lord GOD."
- 45 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 46 *Son of man, set thy face toward the south, and drop thy word toward the south, and prophesy against the forest of the south field;* "Son of man, set Your face toward the south. Preach against the south and prophesy against the forest of the southern region."
- 47 *And say to the forest of the south, Hear the word of the LORD; Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will kindle a fire in thee, and it shall devour every green tree in thee, and every dry tree: the flaming flame shall not be quenched, and all faces from the south to the north shall be burned therein.* "Say to the southern forest: Hear the word of the LORD. This is what the Lord GOD says: I am about to set fire to You, and it will consume every green tree and every dry tree in You. The blazing flame will not be quenched, and every face from south to north will be scorched by it."
- 48 *And all flesh shall see that I the LORD have kindled it: it shall not be quenched.* "Everyone will see that I the LORD have kindled it. It will not be quenched."
- 49 *Then said I, Ah Lord GOD! they say of me, Doth he not speak parables?* Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! People are saying of me, 'Isn't he just telling parables?'"

Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

v6 — Jer 32:22; Ezek 20:15; Ex 3:8

v7 — Lev 18:3; Ezek 20:8

v9 — Ezek 39:7; Ezek 20:22

v11 — Lev 18:5; Rom 10:5

v12 — Ezek 20:20; Ezek 37:28

v13 — Ezek 20:21; Ezek 20:8

v21 — Ezek 20:13; Ezek 20:8

v26 — Ezek 6:7; Isa 63:17; Lev 18:21

v37 — Jer 33:13; Lev 27:32; Matt 25:32-33

v38 — Ezek 13:9; Ps 95:11; Amos 9:9-10

v40 — Isa 56:7; Mal 3:4; Isa 60:7

v41 — Ezek 28:25; Ezek 11:17; Ezek 38:23

Chapter 21

The LORD draws His sword from its sheath against the land of Israel — it is sharpened and polished for slaughter. The king of Babylon stands at the crossroads using divination, and the lot falls on Jerusalem. The crown will be removed until He comes whose right it is.

- 1 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 *Son of man, set thy face toward Jerusalem, and drop thy word toward the holy places, and prophesy against the land of Israel,* "Son of man, set Your face toward Jerusalem. Preach against the sanctuaries and prophesy against the land of Israel."
- 3 *And say to the land of Israel, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I am against thee, and will draw forth my sword out of his sheath, and will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked.* "Say to the land of Israel: This is what the LORD says: I am against You. I will draw My sword from its sheath and cut off from You both the righteous and the wicked."

- 4 *Seeing then that I will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked, therefore shall my sword go forth out of his sheath against all flesh from the south to the north:* "Because I will cut off both the righteous and the wicked, My sword will go out from its sheath against everyone from south to north."
- 5 *That all flesh may know that I the LORD have drawn forth my sword out of his sheath: it shall not return any more.* "Then all flesh will know that I the LORD have drawn My sword from its sheath. It will not return again."
- 6 *Sigh therefore, thou son of man, with the breaking of thy loins; and with bitterness sigh before their eyes.* "Groan, Son of man — groan with anguish and a broken heart before them."
- 7 *And it shall be, when they say unto thee, Wherefore sighest thou? that thou shalt answer, For the tidings; because it cometh: and every heart shall melt, and all hands shall be feeble, and every spirit shall faint, and all knees shall be weak as water: behold, it cometh, and shall be brought to pass, saith the Lord GOD.* "When they ask You why You are groaning, say: Because of the news that is coming. Every heart will melt with fear and every hand will go limp. Every spirit will faint and every knee will be weak as water. It is coming! It will be fulfilled, declares the Lord GOD."
- 8 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 9 *Son of man, prophesy, and say, Thus saith the LORD; Say, A sword, a sword is sharpened, and also furbished:* "Son of man, prophesy and say: This is what the Lord says: A sword, a sword is sharpened and polished —"
- 10 *It is sharpened to make a sore slaughter; it is furbished that it may glitter: should we then make mirth? it contemneth the rod of my son, as every tree.* "sharpened for the slaughter, polished to flash like lightning! Shall we rejoice? The sword despises every wooden scepter."

- 11 *And he gave it to be furbished, that it may be handled: this sword is sharpened, and it is furbished, to give it into the hand of the slayer.* "The sword is handed to the polisher to make it ready for the slayer's hand."
- 12 *Cry and howl, son of man: for it shall be upon my people, it shall be upon all the princes of Israel: terrors by reason of the sword shall be upon my people: smite therefore upon thy thigh.* "Cry out and wail, Son of man, for it is destined for My people. It is for all the princes of Israel. They are thrown to the sword along with My people. Strike Your thigh in grief."
- 13 *Because it is a trial, and what if the sword condemn even the rod? it shall be no more, saith the Lord GOD.* "Testing will surely come. And what if the scepter, which the sword despises, does not continue? declares the Lord GOD."
- 14 *Thou therefore, son of man, prophesy, and smite thine hands together, and let the sword be doubled the third time, the sword of the slain: it is the sword of the great men that are slain, which entereth into their privy chambers.* "So prophesy, Son of man. Clap Your hands together. Let the sword strike twice, even three times. It is the sword for the slain — the sword for the great slaughter that surrounds them."
- 15 *I have set the point of the sword against all their gates, that their heart may faint, and their ruins be multiplied: ah! it is made bright, it is wrapped up for the slaughter.* "I have stationed the sword for slaughter at all their gates, so that hearts will melt with fear and many will stumble. Ah, it is made to flash like lightning! It is drawn for slaughter."
- 16 *Go thee one way or other, either on the right hand, or on the left, whithersoever thy face is set.* "Slash to the right! Slash to the left! Wherever Your blade is aimed!"
- 17 *I will also smite mine hands together, and I will cause my fury to rest: I the LORD have spoken it.* "I too will clap My hands, and My wrath will be spent. I the LORD have spoken."
- 18 *The word of the LORD came unto me again, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:

- 19 *Also, thou son of man, appoint thee two ways, that the sword of the king of Babylon may come: both twain shall come forth out of one land: and choose thou a place, choose it at the head of the way to the city.* "Son of man, mark out two roads for the sword of the king of Babylon to take. Both roads lead from the same country. Make a signpost where the road forks and leads to a city."
- 20 *Appoint a way, that the sword may come to Rabbath of the Ammonites, and to Judah in Jerusalem the defenced.* "Mark out one road for the sword to come to Rabbah of the Ammonites and another to Judah and fortified Jerusalem."
- 21 *For the king of Babylon stood at the parting of the way, at the head of the two ways, to use divination: he made his arrows bright, he consulted with images, he looked in the liver.* "For the king of Babylon will stop at the fork in the road, at the junction of the two roads, to seek an omen. He will cast lots with arrows, he will consult his idols, he will examine the liver."
- 22 *At his right hand was the divination for Jerusalem, to appoint captains, to open the mouth in the slaughter, to lift up the voice with shouting, to appoint battering rams against the gates, to cast a mount, and to build a siege fort.* "Into his right hand will come the lot for Jerusalem, where he is to set up battering rams, to give the command to slaughter, to sound the battle cry, to set battering rams against the gates, to build a siege ramp, and to erect siege works."
- 23 *And it shall be unto them as a false divination in their sight, to them that have sworn oaths: but he will call to remembrance the iniquity, that they may be taken.* "It will seem like a false omen to those who have sworn oaths, but he will remind them of their guilt and take them captive."
- 24 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye have made your iniquity to be remembered, in that your transgressions are discovered, so that in all your doings your sins do appear; because, I say, that ye are come to remembrance, ye shall be taken with the hand.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You have made Your guilt known — your transgressions exposed and Your sins revealed in all You do — because You are brought to remembrance, You will be taken captive."

- 25 *And thou, profane wicked prince of Israel, whose day is come, when iniquity shall have an end,* "And You, profane and wicked prince of Israel, whose day has come — the time of final punishment —"
- 26 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Remove the diadem, and take off the crown: this shall not be the same: exalt him that is low, and abase him that is high.* "this is what the Lord GOD says: Take off the turban. Remove the crown. Things will not remain as they are. Lift up the lowly and bring down the proud."
- 27 *I will overturn, overturn, overturn, it: and it shall be no more, until he come whose right it is; and I will give it him.* "A ruin! A ruin! I will make it a ruin. It will not be restored until He comes to whom it rightfully belongs. To Him I will give it."
- 28 *And thou, son of man, prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning the Ammonites, and concerning their reproach; even say thou, The sword, the sword is drawn: for the slaughter it is furbished, to consume because of the glittering:* "Son of man, prophesy and say: This is what the Lord GOD says about the Ammonites and their contempt: A sword, a sword, drawn for slaughter — polished to consume, to flash like lightning —"
- 29 *Whiles they see vanity unto thee, whiles they divine a lie unto thee, to bring thee upon the necks of them that are slain, of the wicked, whose day is come, when their iniquity shall have an end.* "while false visions are seen for you and lying divinations are told about you. The sword will be laid on the necks of the wicked who are to be slain, whose day has come — the time of final punishment."
- 30 *Shall I cause it to return into his sheath? I will judge thee in the place where thou wast created, in the land of thy nativity.* "Return the sword to its sheath! I will judge you in the place where you were created, in the land of your origin."
- 31 *And I will pour out mine indignation upon thee, I will blow against thee in the fire of my wrath, and I will deliver thee into the hand of brutish men, and skilful to destroy.* "I will pour out My wrath on you and breathe out My fiery anger against you. I will hand you over to brutal men, skilled in destruction."

- 32 *Thou shalt be for fuel to the fire; thy blood shall be in the midst of the land; thou shalt be no more remembered: for I the LORD have spoken it.* "You will be fuel for the fire. Your blood will flow throughout the land. You will be remembered no more, for I the LORD have spoken."

Words in this chapter:

Ammonites (*AM-on-ytes*) — The people of Ammon, descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi — frequently at war with Israel; Nahash and others attacked Israelite territory.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ezek 20:46
 v3 — Jer 21:13; Ezek 5:8; Job 9:22
 v4 — Ezek 20:47
 v5 — Ezek 21:30; Nah 1:9
 v17 — Ezek 5:13
 v20 — Amos 1:14; Jer 49:2
 v22 — Ezek 4:2
 v26 — Ezek 17:24; Ps 75:7
 v27 — Mic 5:2; Jer 23:5-6; Luke 1:32; Zech 9:9; Ps 2:6
 v29 — Ezek 21:25
 v32 — Ezek 25:10

Chapter 22

The LORD catalogs Jerusalem's sins: bloodshed, idolatry, dishonoring parents, oppressing the stranger, profaning the Sabbath. Princes, priests, prophets, and people alike are corrupt. The LORD sought someone to stand in the gap but found no one, and so He pours out His wrath.

- 1 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 *Now, thou son of man, wilt thou judge, wilt thou judge the bloody city? yea, thou shalt shew her all her abominations.* "Son of man, will You judge? Will You judge the city of bloodshed? Confront her with all her abominations."

- 3 *Then say thou, Thus saith the Lord GOD, The city sheddeth blood in the midst of it, that her time may come, and maketh idols against herself to defile herself.* "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: O city that brings on herself doom by shedding blood in her midst and defiles herself by making idols —"
- 4 *Thou art become guilty in thy blood that thou hast shed; and hast defiled thyself in thine idols which thou hast made; and thou hast caused thy days to draw near, and art come even unto thy years: therefore have I made thee a reproach unto the heathen, and a mocking to all countries.* "you have become guilty because of the blood You have shed and have become defiled by the idols You have made. You have brought Your days to a close, and the end of Your years has come. Therefore I have made You an object of scorn to the heathen and a laughingstock to all the countries."
- 5 *Those that be near, and those that be far from thee, shall mock thee, which art infamous and much vexed.* "Those near and far will mock You — infamous city, full of turmoil."
- 6 *Behold, the princes of Israel, every one were in thee to their power to shed blood.* "See how each of the princes of Israel who are in You uses His power to shed blood."
- 7 *In thee have they set light by father and mother: in the midst of thee have they dealt by oppression with the stranger: in thee have they vexed the fatherless and the widow.* "In You they have treated father and mother with contempt. In You they have oppressed the foreigner and mistreated the fatherless and the widow."
- 8 *Thou hast despised mine holy things, and hast profaned my sabbaths.* "You have despised My holy things and desecrated My Sabbaths."
- 9 *In thee are men that carry tales to shed blood: and in thee they eat upon the mountains: in thee have they committed lewdness.* "In You are slanderers bent on shedding blood. In You are those who eat at the mountain shrines and commit indecent acts."
- 10 *In thee have they discovered their fathers' nakedness: in thee have they humbled her that was set apart for pollution.* "In You men violate their fathers' wives. In You men rape women during their periods."

- 11 *And one hath committed abomination with his neighbour's wife; and another hath lewdly defiled his daughter in law; and another in thee hath humbled his sister, his father's daughter.* "In You one man commits a detestable offense with His neighbor's wife. Another shamefully defiles His daughter-in-law. Another violates His sister, His own father's daughter."
- 12 *In thee have they taken gifts to shed blood; thou hast taken usury and increase, and thou hast greedily gained of thy neighbours by extortion, and hast forgotten me, saith the Lord GOD.* "In You people accept bribes to shed blood. You take interest and profit and make gain from Your neighbors by extortion. And You have forgotten Me, declares the Lord GOD."
- 13 *Behold, therefore I have smitten mine hand at thy dishonest gain which thou hast made, and at thy blood which hath been in the midst of thee.* "I will surely strike My hands together at the unjust gain You have made and at the blood that has been shed in You."
- 14 *Can thine heart endure, or can thine hands be strong, in the days that I shall deal with thee? I the LORD have spoken it, and will do it.* "Will Your courage hold out or Your hands remain strong in the day I deal with You? I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it."
- 15 *And I will scatter thee among the heathen, and disperse thee in the countries, and will consume thy filthiness out of thee.* "I will scatter You among the heathen and disperse you through the countries. I will purge You of Your uncleanness."
- 16 *And thou shalt take thine inheritance in thyself in the sight of the heathen, and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.* "When You have been defiled in the eyes of the heathen, you will know that I am the LORD."
- 17 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 *Son of man, the house of Israel is to me become dross: all they are brass, and tin, and iron, and lead, in the midst of the furnace; they are even the dross of silver.* "Son of man, the house of Israel has become worthless to Me. They are all the impurities — bronze, tin, iron, and lead — left inside a furnace. They have become like slag from silver."

- 19 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye are all become dross, behold, therefore I will gather you into the midst of Jerusalem.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You have all become slag, I will gather You into Jerusalem."
- 20 *As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin, into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so will I gather you in mine anger and in my fury, and I will leave you there, and melt you.* "As silver, bronze, iron, lead, and tin are gathered into a furnace to be melted with a blast of fire, so I will gather You in My anger and My wrath. I will put You in the furnace and melt You."
- 21 *Yea, I will gather you, and blow upon you in the fire of my wrath, and ye shall be melted in the midst thereof.* "I will gather You and blow on You with My fiery wrath. You will be melted inside the city."
- 22 *As silver is melted in the midst of the furnace, so shall ye be melted in the midst thereof; and ye shall know that I the LORD have poured out my fury upon you.* "As silver is melted in a furnace, so You will be melted inside the city. Then You will know that I the LORD have poured out My wrath on You."
- 23 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 24 *Son of man, say unto her, Thou art the land that is not cleansed, nor rained upon in the day of indignation.* "Son of man, say to the land: You are a land that has not been cleansed or rained on in the day of wrath."
- 25 *There is a conspiracy of her prophets in the midst thereof, like a roaring lion ravening the prey; they have devoured souls; they have taken the treasure and precious things; they have made her many widows in the midst thereof.* "The conspiracy of her prophets in her midst is like a roaring lion tearing its prey. They devour people. They seize treasure and precious things. They make many widows within her."

- 26 *Her priests have violated my law, and have profaned mine holy things: they have put no difference between the holy and profane, neither have they shewed difference between the unclean and the clean, and have hid their eyes from my sabbaths, and I am profaned among them.* "Her priests do violence to My law and profane My holy things. They do not distinguish between the holy and the common. They do not teach the difference between the unclean and the clean. They shut their eyes to My Sabbaths, and I am profaned among them."
- 27 *Her princes in the midst thereof are like wolves ravening the prey, to shed blood, and to destroy souls, to get dishonest gain.* "Her officials within her are like wolves tearing their prey — shedding blood and destroying lives to make unjust gain."
- 28 *And her prophets have daubed them with untempered mortar, seeing vanity, and divining lies unto them, saying, Thus saith the Lord GOD, when the LORD hath not spoken.* "Her prophets whitewash these deeds with false visions and lying divinations. They say, 'This is what the Lord GOD says,' when the LORD has not spoken."
- 29 *The people of the land have used oppression, and exercised robbery, and have vexed the poor and needy: yea, they have oppressed the stranger wrongfully.* "The people of the land practice extortion and commit robbery. They oppress the poor and needy and mistreat the foreigner, denying them justice."
- 30 *And I sought for a man among them, that should make up the hedge, and stand in the gap before me for the land, that I should not destroy it: but I found none.* "I looked for someone among them who would build up the wall and stand before Me in the gap on behalf of the land so I would not have to destroy it, but I found no one."
- 31 *Therefore have I poured out mine indignation upon them; I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath: their own way have I recompensed upon their heads, saith the Lord GOD.* "So I poured out My wrath on them and consumed them with My fiery anger. I brought down on their own heads all they had done, declares the Lord GOD."

Words in this chapter:

dross (*DROSS*) — the waste metal left after smelting; God says Israel has become dross — worthless impurity to be burned away

profane (*proh-FAYN*) — to treat holy things as common; the priests have profaned God's sabbaths and sanctuary

Cross-References:

v7 — Deut 27:16; Ex 22:21-22

v8 — Ezek 23:38-39; Ezek 22:26; Ezek 20:13

v9 — Hos 4:14

v11 — Lev 20:17; Lev 18:15; 2 Sam 13:14; Lev 18:9

v12 — Ezek 23:35

v14 — Ezek 21:7; Ezek 17:24

v15 — Neh 1:8

v18 — Ps 119:119; Isa 1:22

v26 — Lev 10:10; Ezek 22:8; Ezek 44:23; Mal 2:8

v28 — Ezek 13:6-7; Ezek 13:10-16

v29 — Ezek 22:7; Ex 23:9

v30 — Isa 59:16; Jer 5:1; Ps 106:23; Gen 18:23-32; Ezek 13:5

Chapter 23

The LORD tells the allegory of two sisters, Aholah and Aholibah — Samaria and Jerusalem. Both played the harlot with the nations around them, lusting after Assyria and Babylon. Aholah fell first; yet Aholibah did not learn but surpassed her sister's whoredoms, and judgment comes upon her.

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| <p>1 <i>The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,</i></p> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, there were two women, the daughters of one mother:</i></p> | "Son of man, there were two women, daughters of the same mother." |
| <p>3 <i>And they committed whoredoms in Egypt; they committed whoredoms in their youth: there were their breasts pressed, and there they bruised the teats of their virginity.</i></p> | "They committed whoredoms in Egypt — whoredoms from their youth. Their breasts were pressed there, and the teats of their virginity were handled there." |

- 4 *And the names of them were Aholah the elder, and Aholibah her sister: and they were mine, and they bare sons and daughters. Thus were their names; Samaria is Aholah, and Jerusalem Aholibah.* "The older was named Oholah, and her sister was Oholibah. They were Mine and gave birth to sons and daughters. Oholah is Samaria, and Oholibah is Jerusalem."
- 5 *And Aholah played the harlot when she was mine; and she doted on her lovers, on the Assyrians her neighbours,* "Oholah engaged in whoredom while she was still Mine. She lusted after her lovers — the Assyrians, her neighbors."
- 6 *Which were clothed with blue, captains and rulers, all of them desirable young men, horsemen riding upon horses.* "They were officers dressed in blue, governors and commanders — all handsome young men, mounted horsemen."
- 7 *Thus she committed her whoredoms with them, with all them that were the chosen men of Assyria, and with all on whom she doted: with all their idols she defiled herself.* "She gave herself as a harlot to all the elite men of Assyria, and she defiled herself with all their idols."
- 8 *Neither left she her whoredoms brought from Egypt: for in her youth they lay with her, and they bruised the breasts of her virginity, and poured their whoredom upon her.* "She did not give up the whoredom she had begun in Egypt, where men had slept with her in her youth and fondled her virgin breasts and poured out their lust on her."
- 9 *Wherefore I have delivered her into the hand of her lovers, into the hand of the Assyrians, upon whom she doted.* "Therefore I handed her over to her lovers — the Assyrians, after whom she lusted."
- 10 *These discovered her nakedness: they took her sons and her daughters, and slew her with the sword: and she became famous among women; for they had executed judgment upon her.* "They stripped her naked, took her sons and daughters, and killed her with the sword. She became a byword among women, for judgment was executed on her."

- 11 *And when her sister Aholibah saw this, she was more corrupt in her inordinate love than she, and in her whoredoms more than her sister in her whoredoms.* "Her sister Oholibah saw this, yet in her lust and whoredom she was more depraved than her sister."
- 12 *She doted upon the Assyrians her neighbours, captains and rulers clothed most gorgeously, horsemen riding upon horses, all of them desirable young men.* "She too lusted after the Assyrians — governors and commanders, warriors in full dress, mounted horsemen — all handsome young men."
- 13 *Then I saw that she was defiled, that they took both one way,* "I saw that she too had defiled herself. Both of them had gone the same way."
- 14 *And that she increased her whoredoms: for when she saw men pourtrayed upon the wall, the images of the Chaldeans pourtrayed with vermilion,* "But she carried her whoredom still further. She saw men carved on a wall — figures of Chaldeans drawn in red,"
- 15 *Girded with girdles upon their loins, exceeding in dyed attire upon their heads, all of them princes to look to, after the manner of the Babylonians of Chaldea, the land of their nativity:* "dressed with belts on their waists and flowing turbans on their heads — all of them looked like Babylonian commanders, like men of Chaldea, the land of their birth."
- 16 *And as soon as she saw them with her eyes, she doted upon them, and sent messengers unto them into Chaldea.* "At the sight of them she lusted after them and sent messengers to them in Chaldea."
- 17 *And the Babylonians came to her into the bed of love, and they defiled her with their whoredom, and she was polluted with them, and her mind was alienated from them.* "Then the Babylonians came to her, to the bed of love, and in their lust they defiled her. After she had been defiled by them, she turned away from them in disgust."
- 18 *So she discovered her whoredoms, and discovered her nakedness: then my mind was alienated from her, like as my mind was alienated from her sister.* "When she carried on her whoredom openly and exposed her nakedness, I turned away from her in disgust, just as I had turned away from her sister."

- 19 *Yet she multiplied her whoredoms, in calling to remembrance the days of her youth, wherein she had played the harlot in the land of Egypt.* "Yet she multiplied her whoredom, remembering the days of her youth when she had been a harlot in Egypt."
- 20 *For she doted upon their paramours, whose flesh is as the flesh of asses, and whose issue is like the issue of horses.* "She lusted after their lovers, whose genitals were like those of donkeys and whose emission was like that of horses."
- 21 *So thou calledst to remembrance the lewdness of thy youth, in bruising thy teats by the Egyptians for the paps of thy youth.* "So You longed for the lewdness of Your youth, when in Egypt Your bosom was caressed and Your young breasts fondled."
- 22 *Therefore, O Aholibah, thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will raise up thy lovers against thee, from whom thy mind is alienated, and I will bring them against thee on every side;* "Therefore, Oholibah, this is what the Lord GOD says: I will stir up Your lovers against You — those You turned away from in disgust — and I will bring them against You from every side."
- 23 *The Babylonians, and all the Chaldeans, Pekod, and Shoa, and Koa, and all the Assyrians with them: all of them desirable young men, captains and rulers, great lords and renowned, all of them riding upon horses.* "The Babylonians and all the Chaldeans — the men of Pekod and Shoa and Koa — and all the Assyrians with them, all of them handsome young men, governors and commanders — great lords and renowned warriors — all of them riding horses."
- 24 *And they shall come against thee with chariots, wagons, and wheels, and with an assembly of people, which shall set against thee buckler and shield and helmet round about: and I will set judgment before them, and they shall judge thee according to their judgments.* "They will come against You with weapons, chariots, and wagons, and with a crowd of people. They will take up positions against You on every side with armor and shields and helmets. I will commit the judgment to them, and they will judge You by their own standards."

- 25 *And I will set my jealousy against thee, and they shall deal furiously with thee: they shall take away thy nose and thine ears; and thy remnant shall fall by the sword: they shall take thy sons and thy daughters; and thy residue shall be devoured by the fire.* "I will direct My jealous anger against You, and they will deal with You in fury. They will cut off Your nose and Your ears, and those who are left will fall by the sword. They will take away Your sons and daughters, and Your survivors will be consumed by fire."
- 26 *They shall also strip thee out of thy clothes, and take away thy fair jewels.* "They will also strip off Your clothes and take away Your fine jewelry."
- 27 *Thus will I make thy lewdness to cease from thee, and thy whoredom brought from the land of Egypt: so that thou shalt not lift up thine eyes unto them, nor remember Egypt any more.* "So I will put an end to Your lewdness and the whoredom You began in Egypt. You will not look on these things with longing or remember Egypt anymore."
- 28 *For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will deliver thee into the hand of them whom thou hatest, into the hand of them from whom thy mind is alienated:* "For this is what the Lord GOD says: I am about to hand You over to those You hate — to those You turned away from in disgust."
- 29 *And they shall deal with thee hatefully, and shall take away all thy labour, and shall leave thee naked and bare: and the nakedness of thy whoredoms shall be discovered, both thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.* "They will deal with You in hatred and take everything You have worked for, leaving You naked and bare. The shame of Your whoredom will be exposed — your lewdness and Your whoredoms."
- 30 *I will do these things unto thee, because thou hast gone a whoring after the heathen, and because thou art polluted with their idols.* "These things will be done to You because You have pursued the heathen with lust and defiled yourself with their idols."
- 31 *Thou hast walked in the way of thy sister; therefore will I give her cup into thine hand.* "You have followed in the path of Your sister, so I will put her cup into Your hand."

- 32 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou shalt drink of thy sister's cup deep and large: thou shalt be laughed to scorn and had in derision; it containeth much.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: You will drink Your sister's cup — a cup large and deep. You will be laughed at and mocked. The cup holds so much."
- 33 *Thou shalt be filled with drunkenness and sorrow, with the cup of astonishment and desolation, with the cup of thy sister Samaria.* "You will be filled with drunkenness and sorrow — the cup of ruin and desolation, the cup of Your sister Samaria."
- 34 *Thou shalt even drink it and suck it out, and thou shalt break the sherds thereof, and pluck off thine own breasts: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.* "You will drink it and drain it dry and chew its pieces — and You will tear out Your own breasts. For I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD."
- 35 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast forgotten me, and cast me behind thy back, therefore bear thou also thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You have forgotten Me and thrust Me behind Your back, You must bear the consequences of Your lewdness and whoredom."
- 36 *The LORD said moreover unto me; Son of man, wilt thou judge Aholah and Aholibah? yea, declare unto them their abominations;* The LORD said to me, "Son of man, will You judge Oholah and Oholibah? Confront them with their abominations."
- 37 *That they have committed adultery, and blood is in their hands, and with their idols have they committed adultery, and have also caused their sons, whom they bare unto me, to pass for them through the fire, to devour them.* "For they have committed adultery and blood is on their hands. They committed adultery with their idols and even sacrificed their children — whom they bore to Me — as food for idols."
- 38 *Moreover this they have done unto me: they have defiled my sanctuary in the same day, and have profaned my sabbaths.* "They have also done this to Me: At that same time they defiled My sanctuary and desecrated My Sabbaths."

- 39 *For when they had slain their children to their idols, then they came the same day into my sanctuary to profane it; and, lo, thus have they done in the midst of mine house.* "On the very day they sacrificed their children to their idols, they entered My sanctuary and desecrated it. That is what they did in My house."
- 40 *And furthermore, that ye have sent for men to come from far, unto whom a messenger was sent; and, lo, they came: for whom thou didst wash thyself, paintedst thy face, and deckedst thyself with ornaments,* "They even sent messengers for men who came from far away — when a messenger was sent to them, they came. For their sake You bathed Yourself, painted Your eyes, and put on Your jewelry."
- 41 *And satest upon a stately bed, and a table prepared before it, whereupon thou hast set mine incense and mine oil.* "You sat on an elegant couch with a table spread before it. On it You placed My incense and My oil."
- 42 *And a voice of a multitude being at ease was with her: and with the men of the common sort were brought Sabians from the wilderness, which put bracelets upon their hands, and beautiful crowns upon their heads.* "The noise of a carefree crowd was around her. Drunkards were brought from the desert along with men of the common sort, and they put bracelets on the wrists of Oholah and Oholibah and beautiful crowns on their heads."
- 43 *Then said I unto her that was old in adulteries, Will they now commit whoredoms with her, and she with them?* "Then I said about the one worn out by adultery, 'Now let them use her as a harlot, for that is all she is.'"
- 44 *Yet they went in unto her, as they go in unto a woman that playeth the harlot: so went they in unto Aholah and unto Aholibah, the lewd women.* "And they slept with her as men sleep with a harlot. So they slept with Oholah and Oholibah, these shameless women."
- 45 *And the righteous men, they shall judge them after the manner of adulteresses, and after the manner of women that shed blood; because they are adulteresses, and blood is in their hands.* "But righteous men will sentence them to the punishment due adulteresses and women who shed blood — because they are adulteresses and blood is on their hands."

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| <p>46 <i>For thus saith the Lord GOD; I will bring up a company upon them, and will give them to be removed and spoiled.</i></p> <p>47 <i>And the company shall stone them with stones, and dispatch them with their swords; they shall slay their sons and their daughters, and burn up their houses with fire.</i></p> <p>48 <i>Thus will I cause lewdness to cease out of the land, that all women may be taught not to do after your lewdness.</i></p> <p>49 <i>And they shall recompense your lewdness upon you, and ye shall bear the sins of your idols: and ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.</i></p> | <p>"This is what the Lord GOD says: Bring a mob against them and hand them over to terror and plunder."</p> <p>"The mob will stone them and cut them down with swords. They will kill their sons and daughters and burn down their houses."</p> <p>"So I will put an end to lewdness in the land, that all women may take warning and not imitate Your lewdness."</p> <p>"You will suffer the penalty for Your lewdness and bear the consequences of Your idol worship. Then You will know that I am the Lord GOD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v14 — Ezek 8:10
- v23 — Jer 50:21
- v25 — Ezek 23:47
- v26 — Ezek 16:39
- v27 — Ezek 16:41
- v30 — Ezek 6:9
- v34 — Ps 75:8
- v35 — 1 Kgs 14:9
- v36 — Ezek 22:2
- v37 — Ezek 16:36
- v38 — Ezek 20:13
- v40 — 2 Kgs 9:30; Jer 4:30

Chapter 24

On the very day Nebuchadnezzar begins the siege of Jerusalem, the LORD gives Ezekiel the parable of the boiling pot full of rust and corruption. That evening Ezekiel's wife dies, and the

LORD forbids him to mourn — a sign that when the temple falls, the people's grief will be too great for tears.

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| <p>1 <i>Again in the ninth year, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the ninth year, on the tenth day of the tenth month, the word of the LORD came to me:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, write thee the name of the day, even of this same day: the king of Babylon set himself against Jerusalem this same day.</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, write down this date — this very day — because the king of Babylon has laid siege to Jerusalem this very day."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And utter a parable unto the rebellious house, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Set on a pot, set it on, and also pour water into it:</i></p> | <p>"Tell a parable to that rebellious house and say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: Put on the pot. Put it on and pour water into it."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Gather the pieces thereof into it, even every good piece, the thigh, and the shoulder; fill it with the choice bones.</i></p> | <p>"Put into it the pieces of meat — every good piece, the thigh and the shoulder. Fill it with the best bones."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Take the choice of the flock, and burn also the bones under it, and make it boil well, and let them seethe the bones of it therein.</i></p> | <p>"Take the pick of the flock. Pile the wood beneath it. Bring it to a boil and cook the bones in it."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Wherefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the bloody city, to the pot whose scum is therein, and whose scum is not gone out of it! bring it out piece by piece; let no lot fall upon it.</i></p> | <p>"For this is what the Lord GOD says: How terrible for the city of bloodshed — the pot now encrusted with filth, whose deposit will not go away! Empty it piece by piece without casting lots for the pieces."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>For her blood is in the midst of her; she set it upon the top of a rock; she poured it not upon the ground, to cover it with dust;</i></p> | <p>"For the blood she shed is in her midst. She poured it on the bare rock. She did not pour it on the ground, where the dust would cover it."</p> |

- 8 *That it might cause fury to come up to take vengeance; I have set her blood upon the top of a rock, that it should not be covered.* "To stir up My wrath and take revenge, I put her blood on the bare rock so that it would not be covered."
- 9 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the bloody city! I will even make the pile for fire great.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: How terrible for the city of bloodshed! I too will pile the wood high."
- 10 *Heap on wood, kindle the fire, consume the flesh, and spice it well, and let the bones be burned.* "So heap on the wood and kindle the fire. Cook the meat well, mixing in the spices, and let the bones be charred."
- 11 *Then set it empty upon the coals thereof, that the brass of it may be hot, and may burn, and that the filthiness of it may be molten in it, that the scum of it may be consumed.* "Then set the empty pot on the coals till it becomes hot and its copper glows, so that its impurities may be melted and its deposit burned away."
- 12 *She hath wearied herself with lies, and her great scum went not forth out of her: her scum shall be in the fire.* "It has frustrated all efforts. Its heavy deposit has not been removed — not even by fire."
- 13 *In thy filthiness is lewdness: because I have purged thee, and thou wast not purged, thou shalt not be purged from thy filthiness any more, till I have caused my fury to rest upon thee.* "Now Your impurity is lewdness. Because I tried to cleanse You but You would not be cleansed from Your impurity, You will not be clean again until My wrath against You has subsided."
- 14 *I the LORD have spoken it: it shall come to pass, and I will do it; I will not go back, neither will I spare, neither will I repent; according to thy ways, and according to thy doings, shall they judge thee, saith the Lord GOD.* "I the LORD have spoken. The time has come for Me to act. I will not hold back. I will not have pity. I will not relent. You will be judged according to Your conduct and Your actions, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *Also the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:

- 16 *Son of man, behold, I take away from thee the desire of thine eyes with a stroke: yet neither shalt thou mourn nor weep, neither shall thy tears run down.* "Son of man, with one blow I am about to take away from You the delight of Your eyes. Yet do not lament or weep or let Your tears flow."
- 17 *Forbear to cry, make no mourning for the dead, bind the tire of thine head upon thee, and put on thy shoes upon thy feet, and cover not thy lips, and eat not the bread of men.* "Groan quietly. Do not mourn for the dead. Keep Your turban on Your head and Your sandals on Your feet. Do not cover the lower part of Your face or eat the customary food of mourners."
- 18 *So I spake unto the people in the morning: and at even my wife died; and I did in the morning as I was commanded.* I spoke to the people in the morning, and that evening my wife died. The next morning I did as I had been commanded.
- 19 *And the people said unto me, Wilt thou not tell us what these things are to us, that thou doest so?* The people asked me, "Won't you tell us what these things mean for us? Why are You behaving this way?"
- 20 *Then I answered them, The word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* I answered them, "The word of the LORD came to me:"
- 21 *Speak unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will profane my sanctuary, the excellency of your strength, the desire of your eyes, and that which your soul pitieth; and your sons and your daughters whom ye have left shall fall by the sword.* "Say to the house of Israel: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am about to desecrate My sanctuary — the stronghold You are so proud of, the delight of Your eyes, the desire of Your heart. The sons and daughters You left behind will fall by the sword."
- 22 *And ye shall do as I have done: ye shall not cover your lips, nor eat the bread of men.* "And You will do as I have done. You will not cover the lower part of Your face or eat the bread of mourners."
- 23 *And your tires shall be upon your heads, and your shoes upon your feet: ye shall not mourn nor weep; but ye shall pine away for your iniquities, and mourn one toward another.* "You will keep Your turbans on Your heads and Your sandals on Your feet. You will not mourn or weep but will waste away because of Your sins and groan among yourselves."

- 24 *Thus Ezekiel is unto you a sign: according to all that he hath done shall ye do: and when this cometh, ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.* "Ezekiel will be a sign to you. You will do just as He has done. When this happens, You will know that I am the Lord GOD."
- 25 *Also, thou son of man, shall it not be in the day when I take from them their strength, the joy of their glory, the desire of their eyes, and that whereupon they set their minds, their sons and their daughters,* "And You, Son of man — on the day I take away their stronghold — their joy and pride, the delight of their eyes, their heart's desire — and their sons and daughters as well —"
- 26 *That he that escapeth in that day shall come unto thee, to cause thee to hear it with thine ears?* "on that day a fugitive will come to You and report it to You in person."
- 27 *In that day shall thy mouth be opened to him which is escaped, and thou shalt speak, and be no more dumb: and thou shalt be a sign unto them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "At that time Your mouth will be opened. You will speak with the fugitive and be silent no more. You will be a sign to them, and they will know that I am the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

Ezekiel (*eh-ZEE-kee-el*) — A priest and prophet among the exiles in Babylon — received dramatic visions of God's glory and the future restoration of Israel; his name means 'God strengthens.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

v3 — Ezek 20:49; Ezek 11:3; Ezek 17:2

v6 — Ezek 22:2

v7 — Lev 17:13

v13 — Ezek 22:24; Ezek 5:13

v14 — Matt 16:27

v16 — Jer 22:10

v17 — Hos 9:4

v21 — Ezek 23:47

v24 — Ezek 4:3

Chapter 25

The LORD pronounces judgment against four neighboring nations: Ammon for rejoicing over the temple's destruction, Moab for saying Judah is like all other nations, Edom for taking vengeance on Judah, and the Philistines for acting in revenge with spite. All will know that He is the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>Son of man, set thy face against the Ammonites, and prophesy against them;</i> | "Son of man, set Your face against the Ammonites and prophesy against them." |
| 3 | <i>And say unto the Ammonites, Hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou saidst, Aha, against my sanctuary, when it was profaned; and against the land of Israel, when it was desolate; and against the house of Judah, when they went into captivity;</i> | "Say to the Ammonites: Hear the word of the Lord GOD. This is what the Lord GOD says: Because You said 'Aha!' over My sanctuary when it was desecrated, and over the land of Israel when it was laid waste, and over the house of Judah when they went into exile —" |
| 4 | <i>Behold, therefore I will deliver thee to the men of the east for a possession, and they shall set their palaces in thee, and make their dwellings in thee: they shall eat thy fruit, and they shall drink thy milk.</i> | "therefore I am going to give You to the people of the East as a possession. They will set up their camps and pitch their tents among You. They will eat Your fruit and drink Your milk." |
| 5 | <i>And I will make Rabbah a stable for camels, and the Ammonites a couching place for flocks: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.</i> | "I will turn Rabbah into a pasture for camels and Ammon into a resting place for flocks. Then You will know that I am the LORD." |
| 6 | <i>For thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast clapped thine hands, and stamped with the feet, and rejoiced in heart with all thy despite against the land of Israel;</i> | "For this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You have clapped Your hands and stamped Your feet, rejoicing with all the contempt You felt for the land of Israel —" |

- 7 *Behold, therefore I will stretch out mine hand upon thee, and will deliver thee for a spoil to the heathen; and I will cut thee off from the people, and I will cause thee to perish out of the countries: I will destroy thee; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.* "therefore I will stretch out My hand against You and give You as plunder to the heathen. I will cut you off from the peoples and eliminate You from the countries. I will destroy You, and You will know that I am the LORD."
- 8 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because that Moab and Seir do say, Behold, the house of Judah is like unto all the heathen;* "This is what the Lord GOD says: Because Moab and Seir said, 'Look, the house of Judah has become like all the other heathen' —"
- 9 *Therefore, behold, I will open the side of Moab from the cities, from his cities which are on his frontiers, the glory of the country, Bethjeshimoth, Baalmeon, and Kiriathaim,* "therefore I will expose the flank of Moab, beginning at its frontier towns — Beth Jeshimoth, Baal Meon, and Kiriathaim — the glory of that land."
- 10 *Unto the men of the east with the Ammonites, and will give them in possession, that the Ammonites may not be remembered among the nations.* "I will give it along with Ammon to the people of the East as a possession, so that Ammon will not be remembered among the nations."
- 11 *And I will execute judgments upon Moab; and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "And I will execute judgment on Moab. Then they will know that I am the LORD."
- 12 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because that Edom hath dealt against the house of Judah by taking vengeance, and hath greatly offended, and revenged himself upon them;* "This is what the Lord GOD says: Because Edom took revenge on the house of Judah and became very guilty by doing so —"
- 13 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also stretch out mine hand upon Edom, and will cut off man and beast from it; and I will make it desolate from Teman; and they of Dedan shall fall by the sword.* "therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I will stretch out My hand against Edom and kill its people and their animals. I will lay it waste, and from Teman to Dedan they will fall by the sword."

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| <p>14 <i>And I will lay my vengeance upon Edom by the hand of my people Israel: and they shall do in Edom according to mine anger and according to my fury; and they shall know my vengeance, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because the Philistines have dealt by revenge, and have taken vengeance with a despiteful heart, to destroy it for the old hatred;</i></p> <p>16 <i>Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will stretch out mine hand upon the Philistines, and I will cut off the Cherethims, and destroy the remnant of the sea coast.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And I will execute great vengeance upon them with furious rebukes; and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall lay my vengeance upon them.</i></p> | <p>"I will take vengeance on Edom by the hand of My people Israel, and they will deal with Edom in accordance with My anger and My wrath. They will know My vengeance, declares the Lord GOD."</p> <p>"This is what the Lord GOD says: Because the Philistines acted in vengeance and took revenge with malice in their hearts, destroying Israel with ancient hostility —"</p> <p>"therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I am about to stretch out My hand against the Philistines, and I will cut off the Kerethites and destroy those remaining along the coast."</p> <p>"I will carry out great vengeance on them and punish them in My wrath. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I take vengeance on them."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v3 — Ezek 36:2

v5 — Ezek 21:20

v6 — Obad 1:12; Zeph 2:8

v12 — Jer 49:7-22

v15 — Ezek 25:6

v16 — 1 Sam 30:14; Zeph 2:4-15; Ezek 25:13; Jer 47:1-7

v17 — Ezek 25:14; Ezek 25:11

Chapter 26

The LORD pronounces judgment against Tyre for rejoicing over Jerusalem's fall. Many nations will come against her like waves of the sea. Nebuchadnezzar will besiege her, her walls will be broken down, and her very stones and timbers will be cast into the waters. She will never be rebuilt.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | In the eleventh year, on the first day of the month, the word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>Son of man, because that Tyrus hath said against Jerusalem, Aha, she is broken that was the gate of the people: she is turned unto me: I shall be replenished, now she is laid waste:</i> | "Son of man, because Tyre has said of Jerusalem, 'Aha! The gate of the peoples is broken, and its doors have swung open to me. Now that she lies in ruins, I will prosper' —" |
| 3 | <i>Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Tyrus, and will cause many nations to come up against thee, as the sea causeth his waves to come up.</i> | "therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Tyre, and I will bring many nations against You, like the sea casting up its waves." |
| 4 | <i>And they shall destroy the walls of Tyrus, and break down her towers: I will also scrape her dust from her, and make her like the top of a rock.</i> | "They will destroy the walls of Tyre and pull down her towers. I will scrape away her rubble and make her a bare rock." |
| 5 | <i>It shall be a place for the spreading of nets in the midst of the sea: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD: and it shall become a spoil to the nations.</i> | "Out in the sea she will become a place to spread fishing nets, for I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD. She will become plunder for the nations." |
| 6 | <i>And her daughters which are in the field shall be slain by the sword; and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i> | "Her settlements on the mainland will be ravaged by the sword. Then they will know that I am the LORD." |

- 7 *For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will bring upon Tyrus Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, a king of kings, from the north, with horses, and with chariots, and with horsemen, and companies, and much people.* "For this is what the Lord GOD says: From the north I am going to bring against Tyre Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon — king of kings — with horses and chariots, with horsemen and a great army."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nebuchadnezzar** (neb-uh-kud-NEZ-er) — "Nabu protects the crown" — King of Babylon (605–562 BC), the greatest conqueror of the ancient Near East. He destroyed Jerusalem and its temple in 586 BC and took the Jews into exile in Babylon.

- 8 *He shall slay with the sword thy daughters in the field: and he shall make a fort against thee, and cast a mount against thee, and lift up the buckler against thee.* "He will ravage Your settlements on the mainland with the sword. He will set up siege works against You, build a ramp up to Your walls, and raise His shields against You."
- 9 *And he shall set engines of war against thy walls, and with his axes he shall break down thy towers.* "He will direct the blows of His battering rams against Your walls and demolish Your towers with His weapons."
- 10 *By reason of the abundance of his horses their dust shall cover thee: thy walls shall shake at the noise of the horsemen, and of the wheels, and of the chariots, when he shall enter into thy gates, as men enter into a city wherein is made a breach.* "his horses will be so many that their dust will cover You. Your walls will tremble at the noise of the war horses, wagons, and chariots when He enters Your gates as men enter a city whose walls have been broken through."
- 11 *With the hoofs of his horses shall he tread down all thy streets: he shall slay thy people by the sword, and thy strong garrisons shall go down to the ground.* "The hooves of his horses will trample all Your streets. He will kill Your people with the sword, and Your strong pillars will fall to the ground."

- 12 *And they shall make a spoil of thy riches, and make a prey of thy merchandise: and they shall break down thy walls, and destroy thy pleasant houses: and they shall lay thy stones and thy timber and thy dust in the midst of the water.* "They will plunder Your wealth and loot Your merchandise. They will break down Your walls and demolish Your fine houses and throw Your stones, timber, and rubble into the sea."
- 13 *And I will cause the noise of thy songs to cease; and the sound of thy harps shall be no more heard.* "I will put an end to Your noisy songs, and the music of Your harps will be heard no more."
- 14 *And I will make thee like the top of a rock: thou shalt be a place to spread nets upon; thou shalt be built no more: for I the LORD have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.* "I will make You a bare rock, and You will become a place to spread fishing nets. You will never be rebuilt, for I the LORD have spoken, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *Thus saith the Lord GOD to Tyrus; Shall not the isles shake at the sound of thy fall, when the wounded cry, when the slaughter is made in the midst of thee?* "This is what the Lord GOD says to Tyre: Will not the coastlands tremble at the sound of Your fall, when the wounded groan and the slaughter takes place in Your midst?"
- 16 *Then all the princes of the sea shall come down from their thrones, and lay away their robes, and put off their brodered garments: they shall clothe themselves with trembling; they shall sit upon the ground, and shall tremble at every moment, and be astonished at thee.* "Then all the princes of the coast will step down from their thrones and lay aside their robes and take off their embroidered garments. Clothed with terror, they will sit on the ground, trembling every moment, appalled at You."
- 17 *And they shall take up a lamentation for thee, and say to thee, How art thou destroyed, that wast inhabited of seafaring men, the renowned city, which wast strong in the sea, she and her inhabitants, which cause their terror to be on all that haunt it!* "They will take up a lament concerning You and say to You: 'How You are destroyed, You city of sailors — the renowned city, strong on the sea! She and her inhabitants spread their terror over all who lived there!'"

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| <p>18 <i>Now shall the isles tremble in the day of thy fall; yea, the isles that are in the sea shall be troubled at thy departure.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For thus saith the Lord GOD; When I shall make thee a desolate city, like the cities that are not inhabited; when I shall bring up the deep upon thee, and great waters shall cover thee;</i></p> <p>20 <i>When I shall bring thee down with them that descend into the pit, with the people of old time, and shall set thee in the low parts of the earth, in places desolate of old, with them that go down to the pit, that thou be not inhabited; and I shall set glory in the land of the living;</i></p> <p>21 <i>I will make thee a terror, and thou shalt be no more: though thou be sought for, yet shalt thou never be found again, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> | <p>"Now the coastlands tremble on the day of Your fall. The islands in the sea are terrified at Your end."</p> <p>"For this is what the Lord GOD says: When I make You a desolate city, like cities no longer inhabited, and when I bring the ocean depths over You and its vast waters cover You —"</p> <p>"then I will bring You down with those who go down to the pit, to the people of long ago. I will make you live in the earth below, as in ancient ruins, with those who go down to the pit, and You will not return or take Your place in the land of the living."</p> <p>"I will bring You to a horrible end and You will be no more. You will be sought, but You will never again be found, declares the Lord GOD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 51:42
- v7 — Dan 2:37; Ezra 7:12; Ezek 23:24; Nah 2:3-4
- v15 — Ezek 27:35
- v16 — Ezek 32:10
- v17 — Isa 14:12
- v21 — Ezek 27:36

Chapter 27

Ezekiel takes up a lament for Tyre, depicting her as a magnificent merchant ship built from the finest materials and trading with all the known world. Her riches, wares, and merchants are

catalogued in detail — but she will sink into the heart of the seas, and the nations will be horrified at her end.

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| <p>1 <i>The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Now, thou son of man, take up a lamentation for Tyrus;</i></p> <p>3 <i>And say unto Tyrus, O thou that art situate at the entry of the sea, which art a merchant of the people for many isles, Thus saith the Lord GOD; O Tyrus, thou hast said, I am of perfect beauty.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Thy borders are in the midst of the seas, thy builders have perfected thy beauty.</i></p> <p>5 <i>They have made all thy ship boards of fir trees of Senir: they have taken cedars from Lebanon to make masts for thee.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Of the oaks of Bashan have they made thine oars; the company of the Ashurites have made thy benches of ivory, brought out of the isles of Chittim.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Fine linen with brodered work from Egypt was that which thou spreadest forth to be thy sail; blue and purple from the isles of Elishah was that which covered thee.</i></p> <p>8 <i>The inhabitants of Zidon and Arvad were thy mariners: thy wise men, O Tyrus, that were in thee, were thy pilots.</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD came to me:</p> <p>"Son of man, take up a lament concerning Tyre."</p> <p>"Say to Tyre, situated at the gateway to the sea, merchant of peoples on many coasts: This is what the Lord GOD says: You say, Tyre, 'I am perfect in beauty.'"</p> <p>"Your domain was on the high seas. Your builders brought Your beauty to perfection."</p> <p>"They made all Your planks from pine trees of Senir. They took a cedar from Lebanon to make the mast for You."</p> <p>"Of oaks from Bashan they made Your oars. Of cypress wood from the coasts of Cyprus they made Your deck, inlaid with ivory."</p> <p>"Your sail was of embroidered linen from Egypt and served as Your banner. Your awning was of blue and purple from the coasts of Elishah."</p> <p>"Men of Sidon and Arvad were Your oarsmen. Your skilled men, Tyre, were aboard as Your sailors."</p> |
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- 9 *The ancients of Gebal and the wise men thereof were in thee thy calkers: all the ships of the sea with their mariners were in thee to occupy thy merchandise.* "Veteran craftsmen of Byblos were on board as caulkers of Your seams. All the ships of the sea and their sailors came to You to trade for Your wares."
- 10 *They of Persia and of Lud and of Phut were in thine army, thy men of war: they hanged the shield and helmet in thee; they set forth thy comeliness.* "Men of Persia, Lydia, and Put served as soldiers in Your army. They hung their shields and helmets on Your walls, bringing You splendor."
- 11 *The men of Arvad with thine army were upon thy walls round about, and the Gammadims were in thy towers: they hanged their shields upon thy walls round about; they have made thy beauty perfect.* "Men of Arvad and Helech manned Your walls all around. The men of Gammad were in Your towers. They hung their shields around Your walls and brought Your beauty to perfection."
- 12 *Tarshish was thy merchant by reason of the multitude of all kind of riches; with silver, iron, tin, and lead, they traded in thy fairs.* "Tarshish did business with You because of Your great wealth of goods. They exchanged silver, iron, tin, and lead for Your merchandise."
- 13 *Javan, Tubal, and Meshech, they were thy merchants: they traded the persons of men and vessels of brass in thy market.* "Greece, Tubal, and Meshech traded with You. They bartered human beings and articles of bronze for Your wares."
- 14 *They of the house of Togarmah traded in thy fairs with horses and horsemen and mules.* "From Beth Togarmah they exchanged warhorses, work horses, and mules for Your merchandise."
- 15 *The men of Dedan were thy merchants; many isles were the merchandise of thine hand: they brought thee for a present horns of ivory and ebony.* "The men of Rhodes traded with You, and many coastlands were Your customers. They brought You ivory tusks and ebony as payment."

- 16 *Syria was thy merchant by reason of the multitude of the wares of thy making: they occupied in thy fairs with emeralds, purple, and brodered work, and fine linen, and coral, and agate.* "Aram did business with You because of Your many products. They exchanged turquoise, purple fabric, embroidered work, fine linen, coral, and rubies for Your merchandise."
- 17 *Judah, and the land of Israel, they were thy merchants: they traded in thy market wheat of Minnith, and Pannag, and honey, and oil, and balm.* "Judah and the land of Israel traded with You. They exchanged wheat from Minnith, and confections, honey, olive oil, and balm for Your wares."
- 18 *Damascus was thy merchant in the multitude of the wares of thy making, for the multitude of all riches; in the wine of Helbon, and white wool.* "Damascus did business with You because of Your many products and Your great wealth. They offered wine from Helbon and wool from Zahar."
- 19 *Dan also and Javan going to and fro occupied in thy fairs: bright iron, cassia, and calamus, were in thy market.* "Vedan and Javan from Uzal bought Your merchandise. They exchanged wrought iron, cassia, and calamus for Your wares."
- 20 *Dedan was thy merchant in precious clothes for chariots.* "Dedan traded in saddlecloths for riding."
- 21 *Arabia, and all the princes of Kedar, they occupied with thee in lambs, and rams, and goats: in these were they thy merchants.* "Arabia and all the princes of Kedar were Your customers. They traded with You in lambs, rams, and goats."
- 22 *The merchants of Sheba and Raamah, they were thy merchants: they occupied in thy fairs with chief of all spices, and with all precious stones, and gold.* "The merchants of Sheba and Raamah traded with You. For Your merchandise they exchanged the finest of all spices and precious stones and gold."
- 23 *Haran, and Canneh, and Eden, the merchants of Sheba, Asshur, and Chilmad, were thy merchants.* "Haran, Canneh, and Eden and merchants of Sheba, Asshur, and Kilmad traded with You."

- 24 *These were thy merchants in all sorts of things, in blue clothes, and broidered work, and in chests of rich apparel, bound with cords, and made of cedar, among thy merchandise.* "In Your marketplace they traded with You in choice garments, blue fabric, embroidered work and multicolored rugs, and tightly wound cords."
- 25 *The ships of Tarshish did sing of thee in thy market: and thou wast replenished, and made very glorious in the midst of the seas.* "The ships of Tarshish served as carriers for Your wares. You were filled with heavy cargo as You sailed the sea."
- 26 *Thy rowers have brought thee into great waters: the east wind hath broken thee in the midst of the seas.* "Your oarsmen took You out to the high seas. But the east wind has shattered You in the heart of the sea."
- 27 *Thy riches, and thy fairs, thy merchandise, thy mariners, and thy pilots, thy calkers, and the occupiers of thy merchandise, and all thy men of war, that are in thee, and in all thy company which is in the midst of thee, shall fall into the midst of the seas in the day of thy ruin.* "Your wealth, merchandise, and wares, Your mariners and sailors, Your caulkers, Your merchants and soldiers, and all the other people on board will sink into the heart of the sea on the day of Your shipwreck."
- 28 *The suburbs shall shake at the sound of the cry of thy pilots.* "The coastlands will quake when Your sailors cry out."
- 29 *And all that handle the oar, the mariners, and all the pilots of the sea, shall come down from their ships, they shall stand upon the land;* "All who handle the oars will abandon their ships. The mariners and all the sailors will stand on the shore."
- 30 *And shall cause their voice to be heard against thee, and shall cry bitterly, and shall cast up dust upon their heads, they shall wallow themselves in the ashes:* "They will raise their voice and cry out bitterly over You. They will throw dust on their heads and roll in the ashes."

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| <p>31 <i>And they shall make themselves utterly bald for thee, and gird them with sackcloth, and they shall weep for thee with bitterness of heart and bitter wailing.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And in their wailing they shall take up a lamentation for thee, and lament over thee, saying, What city is like Tyrus, like the destroyed in the midst of the sea?</i></p> <p>33 <i>When thy wares went forth out of the seas, thou filledst many people; thou didst enrich the kings of the earth with the multitude of thy riches and of thy merchandise.</i></p> <p>34 <i>In the time when thou shalt be broken by the seas in the depths of the waters thy merchandise and all thy company in the midst of thee shall fall.</i></p> <p>35 <i>All the inhabitants of the isles shall be astonished at thee, and their kings shall be sore afraid, they shall be troubled in their countenance.</i></p> <p>36 <i>The merchants among the people shall hiss at thee; thou shalt be a terror, and never shalt be any more.</i></p> | <p>"They will shave their heads because of You and put on sackcloth. They will weep over You with anguish of soul and bitter mourning."</p> <p>"In their wailing they will take up a lament concerning You and mourn over You: 'Who was ever silenced like Tyre, surrounded by the sea?'"</p> <p>"When Your merchandise went out on the seas, You satisfied many nations. With Your great wealth and Your wares You enriched the kings of the earth."</p> <p>"Now You are shattered by the sea in the depths of the waters. Your wares and all Your company have gone down with You."</p> <p>"All who live in the coastlands are appalled at You. Their kings shudder with horror and their faces are distorted with fear."</p> <p>"The merchants among the nations hiss at you. You have come to a horrible end and will be no more."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Dan (*DAN*) — Jacob's fifth son, by Bilhah (Rachel's handmaid) — his tribe settled in the far north; his name means 'judge.'

Bashan (*BAY-shan*) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v3 — Ezek 27:4

v5 — Deut 3:9

v6 — Gen 10:4; Isa 2:13

v8 — Gen 10:18

v9 — 1 Kgs 5:18

v10 — Ezek 38:5; Ezek 30:5

v13 — Gen 10:2; Isa 66:19

v14 — Ezek 38:6; Gen 10:3

v17 — Judg 11:33

v21 — Isa 60:7

v22 — Gen 10:7

v31 — Ezek 7:18; Isa 22:12

Chapter 28

The LORD condemns the prince of Tyre, who says "I am a god" in his pride, and declares he will die the death of the uncircumcised. A lament follows for the king of Tyre — once in Eden, full of wisdom and beauty, the anointed cherub on the holy mountain of God — cast down because of his corruption. The LORD also pronounces judgment on Sidon.

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| <p>1 <i>The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD came to me:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, say unto the prince of Tyrus, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thine heart is lifted up, and thou hast said, I am a God, I sit in the seat of God, in the midst of the seas; yet thou art a man, and not God, though thou set thine heart as the heart of God:</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, say to the ruler of Tyre: This is what the Lord GOD says: In the pride of Your heart You say, 'I am a god. I sit on the throne of a god in the heart of the seas.' But You are a mere mortal and not a god, even though You think You are as wise as a god."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Behold, thou art wiser than Daniel; there is no secret that they can hide from thee:</i></p> | <p>"Are You wiser than Daniel? Is no secret hidden from you?"</p> |

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| 4 <i>With thy wisdom and with thine understanding thou hast gotten thee riches, and hast gotten gold and silver into thy treasures:</i> | "By Your wisdom and understanding You have gained wealth for Yourself and amassed gold and silver in Your treasuries." |
| 5 <i>By thy great wisdom and by thy traffick hast thou increased thy riches, and thine heart is lifted up because of thy riches:</i> | "By Your great skill in trading You have increased Your wealth, and because of Your wealth Your heart has grown proud." |
| 6 <i>Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast set thine heart as the heart of God;</i> | "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because You think You are wise — as wise as a god —" |
| 7 <i>Behold, therefore I will bring strangers upon thee, the terrible of the nations: and they shall draw their swords against the beauty of thy wisdom, and they shall defile thy brightness.</i> | "I am going to bring foreigners against You, the most ruthless of nations. They will draw their swords against Your beauty and wisdom and pierce Your shining splendor." |
| 8 <i>They shall bring thee down to the pit, and thou shalt die the deaths of them that are slain in the midst of the seas.</i> | "They will bring You down to the pit, and You will die a violent death in the heart of the seas." |
| 9 <i>Wilt thou yet say before him that slayeth thee, I am God? but thou shalt be a man, and no God, in the hand of him that slayeth thee.</i> | "Will You then say, 'I am a god,' in the presence of those who kill You? You will be just a mortal, not a god, in the hands of those who slay You." |
| 10 <i>Thou shalt die the deaths of the uncircumcised by the hand of strangers: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.</i> | "You will die the death of the uncircumcised at the hands of foreigners. For I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD." |
| 11 <i>Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |

- 12 *Son of man, take up a lamentation upon the king of Tyrus, and say unto him, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou sealest up the sum, full of wisdom, and perfect in beauty.* "Son of man, take up a lament concerning the king of Tyre and say to him: This is what the Lord GOD says: You were the seal of perfection, full of wisdom and perfect in beauty."
- 13 *Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering, the sardius, topaz, and the diamond, the beryl, the onyx, and the jasper, the sapphire, the emerald, and the carbuncle, and gold: the workmanship of thy tabrets and of thy pipes was prepared in thee in the day that thou wast created.* "You were in Eden, the garden of God. Every precious stone adorned You — ruby, topaz, and emerald, chrysolite, onyx, and jasper, lapis lazuli, turquoise, and beryl. Your settings and mountings were made of gold. On the day You were created they were prepared."
- 14 *Thou art the anointed cherub that covereth; and I have set thee so: thou wast upon the holy mountain of God; thou hast walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.* "You were anointed as a guardian cherub, for so I ordained You. You were on the holy mountain of God. You walked among the fiery stones."
- 15 *Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.* "You were blameless in Your ways from the day You were created till iniquity was found in You."
- 16 *By the multitude of thy merchandise they have filled the midst of thee with violence, and thou hast sinned: therefore I will cast thee as profane out of the mountain of God: and I will destroy thee, O covering cherub, from the midst of the stones of fire.* "Through Your widespread trade You were filled with violence, and You sinned. So I drove You in disgrace from the mountain of God, and I expelled You, guardian cherub, from among the fiery stones."
- 17 *Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty, thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness: I will cast thee to the ground, I will lay thee before kings, that they may behold thee.* "Your heart became proud on account of Your beauty. You corrupted Your wisdom because of Your splendor. So I threw You to the earth. I made a spectacle of You before kings."

- 18 *Thou hast defiled thy sanctuaries by the multitude of thine iniquities, by the iniquity of thy traffick; therefore will I bring forth a fire from the midst of thee, it shall devour thee, and I will bring thee to ashes upon the earth in the sight of all them that behold thee.* "By Your many sins and dishonest trade You have desecrated Your sanctuaries. So I made a fire come out from You, and it consumed You. I reduced You to ashes on the ground in the sight of all who were watching."
- 19 *All they that know thee among the people shall be astonished at thee: thou shalt be a terror, and never shalt thou be any more.* "All the nations who knew you are appalled at you. You have come to a horrible end and will be no more."
- 20 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 21 *Son of man, set thy face against Zidon, and prophesy against it,* "Son of man, set Your face against Sidon. Prophesy against it."
- 22 *And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Zidon; and I will be glorified in the midst of thee: and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall have executed judgments in her, and shall be sanctified in her.* "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Sidon, and among You I will display My glory. They will know that I am the LORD when I inflict punishment on her and show Myself holy within her."
- 23 *For I will send into her pestilence, and blood into her streets; and the wounded shall be judged in the midst of her by the sword upon her on every side; and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will send a plague upon her and make blood flow in her streets. The slain will fall within her, with the sword against her on every side. Then they will know that I am the LORD."
- 24 *And there shall be no more a pricking brier unto the house of Israel, nor any grieving thorn of all that are round about them, that despised them; and they shall know that I am the LORD GOD.* "No longer will the people of Israel have malicious neighbors who are painful briars and sharp thorns. Then they will know that I am the Lord GOD."

- 25 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; When I shall have gathered the house of Israel from the people among whom they are scattered, and shall be sanctified in them in the sight of the heathen, then shall they dwell in their land that I have given to my servant Jacob.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: When I gather the people of Israel from the heathen where they have been scattered, I will be proved holy through them in the sight of the heathen. Then they will live in their own land, which I gave to My servant Jacob."
- 26 *And they shall dwell safely therein, and shall build houses, and plant vineyards; yea, they shall dwell with confidence, when I have executed judgments upon all those that despise them round about them; and they shall know that I am the LORD their God.* "They will live there in safety and will build houses and plant vineyards. They will live in safety when I inflict punishment on all their neighbors who treated them with contempt. Then they will know that I am the LORD their God."

Words in this chapter:

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 28:9; 2 Thess 2:4; Isa 14:13-14; Ps 9:20; Prov 16:18

v3 — Dan 1:20; Dan 2:22

v5 — Ps 62:10; Ps 52:7; Hos 13:6; Ezek 28:2

v13 — Ezek 28:15; Gen 2:8; Ezek 27:16; Isa 54:11-12

v14 — Isa 14:12-15; Ex 30:26; Ezek 20:40; Ex 40:9; Ezek 28:13

v15 — 2 Pet 2:4; Ezek 28:17-18; Rom 7:9; Gen 1:26-27; Ezek 28:12

v16 — 1 Tim 6:9-10; Hab 2:8; Hab 2:17

v17 — Ezek 28:5; Prov 16:18; Jas 4:6; Ezek 31:10

v18 — Mal 4:3; Rev 18:8

v24 — Num 33:55; Josh 23:13

v25 — Jer 32:37; Ezek 20:41; Ezek 36:28; Ezek 37:25; Ps 106:47

v26 — Ezek 28:24; Ezek 28:22; Ezek 34:25-28; Amos 9:13-14; Jer 32:15

Chapter 29

The LORD sets His face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, the great dragon lying in his rivers who says "My river is my own; I have made it." Egypt will become a desolation for forty years, then be restored as a lowly kingdom. Nebuchadnezzar will receive the spoils of Egypt as wages for his service against Tyre.

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| <p>1 <i>In the tenth year, in the tenth month, in the twelfth day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the tenth year, on the twelfth day of the tenth month, the word of the LORD came to me:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, set thy face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy against him, and against all Egypt:</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, set your face against Pharaoh king of Egypt and prophesy against him and against all Egypt."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Speak, and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, Pharaoh king of Egypt, the great dragon that lieth in the midst of his rivers, which hath said, My river is mine own, and I have made it for myself.</i></p> | <p>"Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Pharaoh king of Egypt, you great monster lying among Your streams, who says, 'The Nile belongs to me. I made it for myself.'"</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But I will put hooks in thy jaws, and I will cause the fish of thy rivers to stick unto thy scales, and I will bring thee up out of the midst of thy rivers, and all the fish of thy rivers shall stick unto thy scales.</i></p> | <p>"But I will put hooks in Your jaws and make the fish of Your streams stick to Your scales. I will pull You out from among Your streams, with all the fish sticking to Your scales."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And I will leave thee thrown into the wilderness, thee and all the fish of thy rivers: thou shalt fall upon the open fields; thou shalt not be brought together, nor gathered: I will give thee for meat to the beasts of the field and to the fowls of the heaven.</i></p> | <p>"I will leave You in the desert — you and all the fish of Your streams. You will fall on the open field and not be gathered or picked up. I will give You as food to the wild animals and the birds."</p> |

- 6 *And all the inhabitants of Egypt shall know that I am the LORD, because they have been a staff of reed to the house of Israel.* "Then all who live in Egypt will know that I am the LORD. You have been a staff of reed for the house of Israel."
- 7 *When they took hold of thee by thy hand, thou didst break, and rend all their shoulder: and when they leaned upon thee, thou brakest, and madest all their loins to be at a stand.* "When they grasped You with their hands, You splintered and tore open their shoulders. When they leaned on You, You broke and their backs were wrenched."
- 8 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will bring a sword upon thee, and cut off man and beast out of thee.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I will bring a sword against You and kill Your people and their animals."
- 9 *And the land of Egypt shall be desolate and waste; and they shall know that I am the LORD: because he hath said, The river is mine, and I have made it.* "Egypt will become a desolate wasteland. Then they will know that I am the LORD. Because You said, 'The Nile is mine and I made it' —"
- 10 *Behold, therefore I am against thee, and against thy rivers, and I will make the land of Egypt utterly waste and desolate, from the tower of Syene even unto the border of Ethiopia.* "therefore I am against You and against Your streams, and I will make the land of Egypt a ruin and a desolate waste, from Migdol to Aswan, as far as the border of Cush."
- 11 *No foot of man shall pass through it, nor foot of beast shall pass through it, neither shall it be inhabited forty years.* "No foot of man or animal will pass through it. No one will live there for forty years."
- 12 *And I will make the land of Egypt desolate in the midst of the countries that are desolate, and her cities among the cities that are laid waste shall be desolate forty years: and I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries.* "I will make the land of Egypt desolate among devastated lands, and her cities will lie desolate forty years among ruined cities. I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations and disperse them through the countries."

- 13 *Yet thus saith the Lord GOD; At the end of forty years will I gather the Egyptians from the people whither they were scattered:* "Yet this is what the Lord GOD says: At the end of forty years I will gather the Egyptians from the nations where they were scattered."
- 14 *And I will bring again the captivity of Egypt, and will cause them to return into the land of Pathros, into the land of their habitation; and they shall be there a base kingdom.* "I will bring Egypt back from captivity and return them to Upper Egypt, the land of their origin. There they will be a lowly kingdom."
- 15 *It shall be the basest of the kingdoms; neither shall it exalt itself any more above the nations: for I will diminish them, that they shall no more rule over the nations.* "It will be the lowliest of kingdoms and will never again exalt itself above the other nations. I will make it so weak that it will never again rule over the nations."
- 16 *And it shall be no more the confidence of the house of Israel, which bringeth their iniquity to remembrance, when they shall look after them: but they shall know that I am the Lord GOD.* "Egypt will no longer be a source of confidence for the people of Israel but will remind them of their sin in turning to her for help. Then they will know that I am the Lord GOD."
- 17 *And it came to pass in the seven and twentieth year, in the first month, in the first day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* In the twenty-seventh year, on the first day of the first month, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 *Son of man, Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon caused his army to serve a great service against Tyrus: every head was made bald, and every shoulder was peeled: yet had he no wages, nor his army, for Tyrus, for the service that he had served against it:* "Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon drove his army in a hard campaign against Tyre. Every head was rubbed bare and every shoulder made raw. Yet he and his army got no reward from Tyre for the campaign he had led against it."

- 19 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will give the land of Egypt unto Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon; and he shall take her multitude, and take her spoil, and take her prey; and it shall be the wages for his army.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I am going to give Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will carry off its wealth. He will loot and plunder it as pay for His army."
- 20 *I have given him the land of Egypt for his labour wherewith he served against it, because they wrought for me, saith the Lord GOD.* "I have given Him Egypt as a reward for His efforts because He and His army did it for Me, declares the Lord GOD."
- 21 *In that day will I cause the horn of the house of Israel to bud forth, and I will give thee the opening of the mouth in the midst of them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "On that day I will make a horn of the house of Israel grow, and I will open Your mouth among them. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

Words in this chapter:

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Ezek 32:2; Isa 27:1; Jer 44:30
 v4 — 2 Kgs 19:28; Ezek 38:4
 v6 — Isa 36:6; 2 Kgs 18:21
 v7 — Isa 36:6
 v8 — Ezek 14:17
 v11 — Ezek 32:13
 v12 — Ezek 30:7; Ezek 30:23; Jer 46:19
 v14 — Ezek 30:14; Isa 11:11
 v19 — Jer 43:10-13; Ezek 30:24-25
 v21 — Luke 21:15; Ps 132:17; 1 Sam 2:10; Amos 3:7-8

Chapter 30

The LORD declares a day of doom for Egypt and her allies. The sword of Babylon will come against her, the rivers will be dried up, the idols destroyed, and the cities laid waste from Migdol to Syene. The LORD will break the arms of Pharaoh and strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon.

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| 1 <i>The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 <i>Son of man, prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Howl ye, Woe worth the day!</i> | "Son of man, prophesy and say: This is what the Lord GOD says: Wail and say, 'Alas for that day!'" |
| 3 <i>For the day is near, even the day of the LORD is near, a cloudy day; it shall be the time of the heathen.</i> | "For the day is near — the day of the LORD is near. It will be a day of clouds, a time of reckoning for the heathen." |
| 4 <i>And the sword shall come upon Egypt, and great pain shall be in Ethiopia, when the slain shall fall in Egypt, and they shall take away her multitude, and her foundations shall be broken down.</i> | "A sword will come against Egypt, and anguish will come upon Cush. When the slain fall in Egypt, her wealth will be carried away and her foundations torn down." |
| 5 <i>Ethiopia, and Libya, and Lydia, and all the mingled people, and Chub, and the men of the land that is in league, shall fall with them by the sword.</i> | "Cush and Put, Lydia and all Arabia, Libya and the people of the covenant land — they will all fall by the sword along with Egypt." |
| 6 <i>Thus saith the LORD; They also that uphold Egypt shall fall; and the pride of her power shall come down: from the tower of Syene shall they fall in it by the sword, saith the Lord GOD.</i> | "This is what the LORD says: The allies of Egypt will fall, and her proud strength will fail. From Migdol to Aswan they will fall by the sword within Egypt, declares the Lord GOD." |
| 7 <i>And they shall be desolate in the midst of the countries that are desolate, and her cities shall be in the midst of the cities that are wasted.</i> | "They will be desolate among desolate lands. Their cities will be among ruined cities." |
| 8 <i>And they shall know that I am the LORD, when I have set a fire in Egypt, and when all her helpers shall be destroyed.</i> | "They will know that I am the LORD when I set fire to Egypt and all her helpers are crushed." |

- 9 *In that day shall messengers go forth from me in ships to make the careless Ethiopians afraid, and great pain shall come upon them, as in the day of Egypt: for, lo, it cometh.* "On that day messengers will go out from Me in ships to frighten Cush out of her complacency. Anguish will take hold of them on the day of Egypt's doom, for it is surely coming."
- 10 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also make the multitude of Egypt to cease by the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: I will put an end to the hordes of Egypt by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon."
- 11 *He and his people with him, the terrible of the nations, shall be brought to destroy the land: and they shall draw their swords against Egypt, and fill the land with the slain.* "He and His army — the most ruthless of nations — will be brought in to destroy the land. They will draw their swords against Egypt and fill the land with the slain."
- 12 *And I will make the rivers dry, and sell the land into the hand of the wicked: and I will make the land waste, and all that is therein, by the hand of strangers: I the LORD have spoken it.* "I will dry up the streams of the Nile and sell the land to evil men. By the hand of foreigners I will lay waste the land and everything in it. I the LORD have spoken."
- 13 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also destroy the idols, and I will cause their images to cease out of Noph; and there shall be no more a prince of the land of Egypt: and I will put a fear in the land of Egypt.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: I will destroy the idols and put an end to the images in Memphis. No longer will there be a prince in Egypt, and I will spread fear throughout the land."
- 14 *And I will make Pathros desolate, and will set fire in Zoan, and will execute judgments in No.* "I will lay waste Upper Egypt, set fire to Zoan, and inflict punishment on Thebes."
- 15 *And I will pour my fury upon Sin, the strength of Egypt; and I will cut off the multitude of No.* "I will pour out My wrath on Pelusium, the stronghold of Egypt, and cut off the hordes of Thebes."

- 16 *And I will set fire in Egypt: Sin shall have great pain, and No shall be rent asunder, and Noph shall have distresses daily.* "I will set fire to Egypt. Pelusium will writhe in agony. Thebes will be torn apart. Memphis will be in constant distress."
- 17 *The young men of Aven and of Pibeseth shall fall by the sword: and these cities shall go into captivity.* "The young men of Heliopolis and Bubastis will fall by the sword, and the cities will go into captivity."
- 18 *At Tehaphnehes also the day shall be darkened, when I shall break there the yokes of Egypt: and the pride of her power shall cease in her: as for her, a cloud shall cover her, and her daughters shall go into captivity.* "Dark will be the day at Tahpanhes when I break the yoke of Egypt. There her proud strength will come to an end. She will be covered with clouds, and her villages will go into captivity."
- 19 *Thus will I execute judgments in Egypt: and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "So I will inflict punishment on Egypt, and they will know that I am the LORD."
- 20 *And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first month, in the seventh day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* In the eleventh year, on the seventh day of the first month, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 21 *Son of man, I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt; and, lo, it shall not be bound up to be healed, to put a roller to bind it, to make it strong to hold the sword.* "Son of man, I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt. It has not been bound up for healing or wrapped with a bandage so that it may become strong enough to hold a sword."
- 22 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and will break his arms, the strong, and that which was broken; and I will cause the sword to fall out of his hand.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt. I will break both his arms — the good arm as well as the broken one — and make the sword fall from His hand."
- 23 *And I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries.* "I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations and disperse them through the countries."

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| <p>24 <i>And I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and put my sword in his hand: but I will break Pharaoh's arms, and he shall groan before him with the groanings of a deadly wounded man.</i></p> <p>25 <i>But I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and the arms of Pharaoh shall fall down; and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall put my sword into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall stretch it out upon the land of Egypt.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and disperse them among the countries; and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon and put My sword in his hand. But I will break the arms of Pharaoh, and he will groan before the king of Babylon like a mortally wounded man."</p> <p>"I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, but the arms of Pharaoh will fall limp. They will know that I am the LORD when I put My sword into the hand of the king of Babylon and he brandishes it against Egypt."</p> <p>"I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations and disperse them through the countries. Then they will know that I am the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Isa 13:6
- v3 — Obad 1:15; Joel 2:1-2
- v4 — Ezek 29:19
- v5 — Jer 25:20
- v7 — Ezek 29:12
- v9 — Isa 18:1-2
- v10 — Ezek 29:19
- v11 — Ezek 28:7
- v14 — Jer 46:25; Ezek 29:14
- v21 — Jer 46:11; Jer 30:13; Ps 37:17; Jer 48:25

Chapter 31

The LORD compares Pharaoh to a great cedar in Lebanon — towering above all the trees, its top among the thick branches, envied by all the trees of Eden. But because it grew proud, it

was cut down and cast to the earth by the most terrible of the nations, and all who dwelt in its shade departed.

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| 1 <i>And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the third month, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | In the eleventh year, on the first day of the third month, the word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 <i>Son of man, speak unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, and to his multitude; Whom art thou like in thy greatness?</i> | "Son of man, say to Pharaoh king of Egypt and to his hordes: Who can be compared with you in your greatness?" |
| 3 <i>Behold, the Assyrian was a cedar in Lebanon with fair branches, and with a shadowing shroud, and of an high stature; and his top was among the thick boughs.</i> | "Consider Assyria, once a cedar in Lebanon, with beautiful branches overshadowing the forest. It towered high, its top above the thick foliage." |
| 4 <i>The waters made him great, the deep set him up on high with her rivers running round about his plants, and sent out her little rivers unto all the trees of the field.</i> | "The waters nourished it and the deep springs made it grow tall. Their streams flowed all around its base and sent their channels to all the trees of the field." |
| 5 <i>Therefore his height was exalted above all the trees of the field, and his boughs were multiplied, and his branches became long because of the multitude of waters, when he shot forth.</i> | "So it towered higher than all the trees of the field. Its boughs multiplied and its branches grew long, spreading because of the abundant water." |
| 6 <i>All the fowls of heaven made their nests in his boughs, and under his branches did all the beasts of the field bring forth their young, and under his shadow dwelt all great nations.</i> | "All the birds of the sky nested in its boughs. All the wild animals gave birth under its branches. All the great nations lived in its shade." |
| 7 <i>Thus was he fair in his greatness, in the length of his branches: for his root was by great waters.</i> | "It was majestic in beauty with its spreading boughs, for its roots reached down to abundant waters." |

- 8 *The cedars in the garden of God could not hide him: the fir trees were not like his boughs, and the chestnut trees were not like his branches; nor any tree in the garden of God was like unto him in his beauty.* "The cedars in the garden of God could not rival it, nor could the junipers equal its boughs, nor the plane trees compare with its branches. No tree in the garden of God could match its beauty."
- 9 *I have made him fair by the multitude of his branches: so that all the trees of Eden, that were in the garden of God, envied him.* "I made it beautiful with abundant branches, the envy of all the trees of Eden in the garden of God."
- 10 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast lifted up thyself in height, and he hath shot up his top among the thick boughs, and his heart is lifted up in his height;* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because it towered on high and set its top among the thick boughs, and because it was proud of its height —"
- 11 *I have therefore delivered him into the hand of the mighty one of the heathen; he shall surely deal with him: I have driven him out for his wickedness.* "I handed it over to the ruler of the heathen, for him to deal with according to its wickedness. I cast it aside."
- 12 *And strangers, the terrible of the nations, have cut him off, and have left him: upon the mountains and in all the valleys his branches are fallen, and his boughs are broken by all the rivers of the land; and all the people of the earth are gone down from his shadow, and have left him.* "The most ruthless of foreign nations cut it down and left it. Its branches fell on the mountains and in all the valleys. Its boughs lay broken in all the ravines of the land. All the nations of the earth left its shade and went away."
- 13 *Upon his ruin shall all the fowls of the heaven remain, and all the beasts of the field shall be upon his branches:* "All the birds settled on the fallen tree, and all the wild animals lived among its branches."

- 14 *To the end that none of all the trees by the waters exalt themselves for their height, neither shoot up their top among the thick boughs, neither their trees stand up in their height, all that drink water: for they are all delivered unto death, to the nether parts of the earth, in the midst of the children of men, with them that go down to the pit.* "No other trees by the waters are to grow tall and set their tops among the thick foliage. No other well-watered tree is to reach such a height. They are all destined for death — for the depths of the earth — among mortals who go down to the pit."
- 15 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day when he went down to the grave I caused a mourning: I covered the deep for him, and I restrained the floods thereof, and the great waters were stayed: and I caused Lebanon to mourn for him, and all the trees of the field fainted for him.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: On the day it was brought down to hell I caused mourning. I covered the deep springs with darkness for it, I held back its streams, and the great waters were restrained. I made Lebanon mourn for it, and all the trees of the field withered away."
- 16 *I made the nations to shake at the sound of his fall, when I cast him down to hell with them that descend into the pit: and all the trees of Eden, the choice and best of Lebanon, all that drink water, shall be comforted in the nether parts of the earth.* "I made the nations tremble at the sound of its fall when I brought it down to hell with those who go down to the pit. Then all the trees of Eden, the finest and best of Lebanon — all the trees that were well-watered — were consoled in the depths of the earth."
- 17 *They also went down into hell with him unto them that be slain with the sword; and they that were his arm, that dwelt under his shadow in the midst of the heathen.* "They too, like the great tree, had gone down to hell, to those killed by the sword — those who had lived in its shade among the heathen."

- 18 *To whom art thou thus like in glory and in greatness among the trees of Eden? yet shalt thou be brought down with the trees of Eden unto the nether parts of the earth: thou shalt lie in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord GOD.* "Which of the trees of Eden can be compared with You in glory and greatness? Yet You too will be brought down with the trees of Eden to the depths of the earth. You will lie among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his hordes, declares the Lord GOD."
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 30:20
- v3 — Isa 10:33-34
- v6 — Matt 13:32; Ezek 17:23
- v8 — Ezek 28:13
- v12 — Ezek 28:7
- v13 — Ezek 32:4
- v16 — Isa 14:15; Isa 14:8; Ezek 26:15
- v18 — Ezek 32:19

Chapter 32

Ezekiel takes up a lament for Pharaoh, comparing him to a great monster in the seas. The LORD will cast His net over Egypt and leave her carcass on the open field for the birds and beasts. Egypt will descend to the pit and lie among the uncircumcised with Assyria, Elam, Meshech, Tubal, Edom, and Sidon.

- 1 *And it came to pass in the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* In the twelfth year, on the first day of the twelfth month, the word of the LORD came to me:

- 2 *Son of man, take up a lamentation for Pharaoh king of Egypt, and say unto him, Thou art like a young lion of the nations, and thou art as a whale in the seas: and thou camest forth with thy rivers, and troubledst the waters with thy feet, and fouledst their rivers.* "Son of man, take up a lament concerning Pharaoh king of Egypt and say to him: You are like a lion among the nations. You are like a monster in the seas, thrashing about in your streams, churning the water with your feet and muddying the streams."
- 3 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will therefore spread out my net over thee with a company of many people; and they shall bring thee up in my net.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: With a great throng of people I will cast My net over You, and they will haul You up in My net."
- 4 *Then will I leave thee upon the land, I will cast thee forth upon the open field, and will cause all the fowls of the heaven to remain upon thee, and I will fill the beasts of the whole earth with thee.* "I will throw You on the land and hurl You on the open field. I will let all the birds of the sky settle on You and all the wild animals gorge themselves on You."
- 5 *And I will lay thy flesh upon the mountains, and fill the valleys with thy height.* "I will spread Your flesh on the mountains and fill the valleys with Your remains."
- 6 *I will also water with thy blood the land wherein thou swimmest, even to the mountains; and the rivers shall be full of thee.* "I will drench the land with Your flowing blood all the way to the mountains, and the ravines will be filled with Your flesh."
- 7 *And when I shall put thee out, I will cover the heaven, and make the stars thereof dark; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall not give her light.* "When I snuff You out, I will cover the heavens and darken their stars. I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon will not give its light."
- 8 *All the bright lights of heaven will I make dark over thee, and set darkness upon thy land, saith the Lord GOD.* "All the shining lights in the heavens I will darken over You. I will bring darkness over Your land, declares the Lord GOD."

- 9 *I will also vex the hearts of many people, when I shall bring thy destruction among the nations, into the countries which thou hast not known.* "I will trouble the hearts of many peoples when I bring about Your destruction among the nations — among lands you have not known."
- 10 *Yea, I will make many people amazed at thee, and their kings shall be horribly afraid for thee, when I shall brandish my sword before them; and they shall tremble at every moment, every man for his own life, in the day of thy fall.* "I will cause many peoples to be appalled at You, and their kings will shudder with horror because of You when I brandish My sword before them. On the day of Your downfall each of them will tremble every moment for His own life."
- 11 *For thus saith the Lord GOD; The sword of the king of Babylon shall come upon thee.* "For this is what the Lord GOD says: The sword of the king of Babylon will come against you."
- 12 *By the swords of the mighty will I cause thy multitude to fall, the terrible of the nations, all of them: and they shall spoil the pomp of Egypt, and all the multitude thereof shall be destroyed.* "By the swords of the mighty I will cause Your hordes to fall — the ruthless of all nations. They will shatter the pride of Egypt, and all its hordes will be destroyed."
- 13 *I will destroy also all the beasts thereof from beside the great waters; neither shall the foot of man trouble them any more, nor the hoofs of beasts trouble them.* "I will destroy all her cattle from beside abundant waters. No human foot will trouble them anymore, nor will the hooves of cattle churn them up."
- 14 *Then will I make their waters deep, and cause their rivers to run like oil, saith the Lord GOD.* "Then I will let her waters settle and make her streams flow like oil, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *When I shall make the land of Egypt desolate, and the country shall be destitute of that whereof it was full, when I shall smite all them that dwell therein, then shall they know that I am the LORD.* "When I make Egypt desolate and strip the land of everything in it — when I strike down all who live there — then they will know that I am the LORD."

- 16 *This is the lamentation wherewith they shall lament her: the daughters of the nations shall lament her: they shall lament for her, even for Egypt, and for all her multitude, saith the Lord GOD.* "This is the lament they will chant for her. The women of the nations will chant it. They will chant it over Egypt and all her hordes, declares the Lord GOD."
- 17 *It came to pass also in the twelfth year, in the fifteenth day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* In the twelfth year, on the fifteenth day of the month, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 *Son of man, wail for the multitude of Egypt, and cast them down, even her, and the daughters of the famous nations, unto the nether parts of the earth, with them that go down into the pit.* "Son of man, wail for the hordes of Egypt and consign to the earth below both her and the daughters of mighty nations, along with those who go down to the pit."
- 19 *Whom dost thou pass in beauty? go down, and be thou laid with the uncircumcised.* "Say: Are You more favored than others? Go down and be laid among the uncircumcised."
- 20 *They shall fall in the midst of them that are slain by the sword: she is delivered to the sword: draw her and all her multitudes.* "They will fall among those killed by the sword. The sword is drawn. Drag her away and all her hordes."
- 21 *The strong among the mighty shall speak to him out of the midst of hell with them that help him: they are gone down, they lie uncircumcised, slain by the sword.* "From within hell the mighty leaders will say of Egypt and her allies: 'They have come down and they lie with the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword.'"
- 22 *Asshur is there and all her company: his graves are about him: all of them slain, fallen by the sword:* "Assyria is there with her whole army. Her graves are all around her. All of them are slain, fallen by the sword."

- 23 *Whose graves are set in the sides of the pit, and her company is round about her grave: all of them slain, fallen by the sword, which caused terror in the land of the living.* "Their graves are in the depths of the pit and her army lies around her grave. All of them fell by the sword — those who had spread terror in the land of the living."
- 24 *There is Elam and all her multitude round about her grave, all of them slain, fallen by the sword, which are gone down uncircumcised into the nether parts of the earth, which caused their terror in the land of the living; yet have they borne their shame with them that go down to the pit.* "Elam is there with all her hordes around her grave. All of them fell by the sword — uncircumcised, gone down to the depths of the earth. They had spread their terror in the land of the living, but they bear their shame with those who go down to the pit."
- 25 *They have set her a bed in the midst of the slain with all her multitude: her graves are round about him: all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword: though their terror was caused in the land of the living, yet have they borne their shame with them that go down to the pit: he is put in the midst of them that be slain.* "A bed is made for her among the slain, with all her hordes around her grave. All of them are uncircumcised, killed by the sword. Because their terror was spread in the land of the living, they bear their shame with those who go down to the pit. She is laid among the slain."
- 26 *There is Meshech, Tubal, and all her multitude: her graves are round about him: all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword, though they caused their terror in the land of the living.* "Meshech and Tubal are there, with all their hordes around their graves. All of them are uncircumcised, killed by the sword, though they spread their terror in the land of the living."

- 27 *And they shall not lie with the mighty that are fallen of the uncircumcised, which are gone down to hell with their weapons of war: and they have laid their swords under their heads, but their iniquities shall be upon their bones, though they were the terror of the mighty in the land of the living.* "Do they not lie with the other uncircumcised warriors who have fallen, who went down to hell with their weapons of war, whose swords were placed under their heads? The punishment for their sins rested on their bones, though the terror of these warriors had stalked through the land of the living."
- 28 *Yea, thou shalt be broken in the midst of the uncircumcised, and shalt lie with them that are slain with the sword.* "You too, Pharaoh, will be broken and will lie among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword."
- 29 *There is Edom, her kings, and all her princes, which with their might are laid by them that were slain by the sword: they shall lie with the uncircumcised, and with them that go down to the pit.* "Edom is there, her kings and all her princes. Despite their power, they are laid with those killed by the sword. They lie with the uncircumcised, with those who go down to the pit."
- 30 *There be the princes of the north, all of them, and all the Zidonians, which are gone down with the slain; with their terror they are ashamed of their might; and they lie uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword, and bear their shame with them that go down to the pit.* "All the princes of the north and all the Sidonians are there. They went down with the slain in disgrace despite the terror caused by their power. They lie uncircumcised with those killed by the sword and bear their shame with those who go down to the pit."
- 31 *Pharaoh shall see them, and shall be comforted over all his multitude, even Pharaoh and all his army slain by the sword, saith the Lord GOD.* "Pharaoh — he and all his army — will see them and find comfort for all His hordes killed by the sword, declares the Lord GOD."

- 32 *For I have caused my terror in the land of the living; and he shall be laid in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that are slain with the sword, even Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord GOD.* "Although I had Him spread terror in the land of the living, Pharaoh and all his hordes will be laid among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword, declares the Lord GOD."

Words in this chapter:

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 29:3; Nah 2:11-13
 v3 — Ezek 12:13; Jer 16:16
 v7 — Matt 24:29; Joel 2:31; Isa 34:4; Isa 13:10; Ezek 30:3
 v10 — Ezek 27:35; Ezek 26:16
 v12 — Ezek 28:7
 v13 — Ezek 29:11
 v15 — Ezek 6:7; Ex 7:5
 v17 — Ezek 32:1
 v18 — Ezek 32:2; Ezek 31:14
 v19 — Ezek 32:29-30; Ezek 31:18
 v23 — Ezek 26:20
 v26 — Ezek 27:13; Gen 10:2

Chapter 33

The LORD restates Ezekiel's role as watchman for the house of Israel. He reaffirms that the righteous who turns to sin will die, and the wicked who repents will live. News arrives that Jerusalem has fallen. The LORD rebukes those still in the ruins who claim the land by right of Abraham, and He warns that the exiles listen to Ezekiel's words but do not act on them.

- 1 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 *Son of man, speak to the children of thy people, and say unto them, When I bring the sword upon a land, if the people of the land take a man of their coasts, and set him for their watchman:* "Son of man, speak to Your people and say to them: When I bring a sword against a land, and the people of the land choose one of their men and make Him their watchman —"

- 3 *If when he seeth the sword come upon the land, he blow the trumpet, and warn the people;* "and He sees the sword coming against the land and blows the trumpet to warn the people —"
- 4 *Then whosoever heareth the sound of the trumpet, and taketh not warning; if the sword come, and take him away, his blood shall be upon his own head.* "then if anyone hears the trumpet but does not take warning and the sword comes and takes His life, His blood will be on His own head."
- 5 *He heard the sound of the trumpet, and took not warning; his blood shall be upon him. But he that taketh warning shall deliver his soul.* "Since He heard the sound of the trumpet but did not take warning, His blood will be on His own head. If He had taken warning, He would have saved Himself."
- 6 *But if the watchman see the sword come, and blow not the trumpet, and the people be not warned; if the sword come, and take any person from among them, he is taken away in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at the watchman's hand.* "But if the watchman sees the sword coming and does not blow the trumpet to warn the people and the sword comes and takes someone's life, that person's life will be taken because of their sin, but I will hold the watchman responsible for their blood."
- 7 *So thou, O son of man, I have set thee a watchman unto the house of Israel; therefore thou shalt hear the word at my mouth, and warn them from me.* "Son of man, I have made You a watchman for the house of Israel. So hear the word I speak and give them warning from Me."
- 8 *When I say unto the wicked, O wicked man, thou shalt surely die; if thou dost not speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.* "When I say to the wicked, 'You wicked person, you will surely die,' and you do not speak out to dissuade them from their ways, that wicked person will die for their sin, and I will hold you responsible for their blood."
- 9 *Nevertheless, if thou warn the wicked of his way to turn from it; if he do not turn from his way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.* "But if you do warn the wicked person to turn from their ways and they do not do so, they will die for their sin, though you yourself will have been delivered."

- 10 *Therefore, O thou son of man, speak unto the house of Israel; Thus ye speak, saying, If our transgressions and our sins be upon us, and we pine away in them, how should we then live?* "Son of man, say to the house of Israel: 'This is what you are saying: Our offenses and sins weigh us down, and we are wasting away because of them. How then can we live?'"
- 11 *Say unto them, As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked; but that the wicked turn from his way and live: turn ye, turn ye from your evil ways; for why will ye die, O house of Israel?* "Say to them: As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I take no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but rather that they turn from their ways and live. Turn! Turn from Your evil ways! Why will You die, house of Israel?"
- 12 *Therefore, thou son of man, say unto the children of thy people, The righteousness of the righteous shall not deliver him in the day of his transgression: as for the wickedness of the wicked, he shall not fall thereby in the day that he turneth from his wickedness; neither shall the righteous be able to live for his righteousness in the day that he sinneth.* "Son of man, say to your people: The righteousness of the righteous will not save them when they disobey. As for the wickedness of the wicked, they will not fall by it when they turn from it. The righteous person will not be able to live by their righteousness when they sin."
- 13 *When I shall say to the righteous, that he shall surely live; if he trust to his own righteousness, and commit iniquity, all his righteousnesses shall not be remembered; but for his iniquity that he hath committed, he shall die for it.* "If I tell the righteous person that they will surely live, but then they trust in their righteousness and do evil, none of their righteous acts will be remembered. They will die for the evil they have done."
- 14 *Again, when I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; if he turn from his sin, and do that which is lawful and right;* "And if I say to the wicked, 'You will surely die,' but they then turn away from their sin and do what is just and right —"

- 15 *If the wicked restore the pledge, give again that he had robbed, walk in the statutes of life, without committing iniquity; he shall surely live, he shall not die.* "if they return what they took as a pledge for a loan, give back what they have stolen, follow the decrees that give life, and do no evil — they will surely live. They will not die."
- 16 *None of his sins that he hath committed shall be mentioned unto him: he hath done that which is lawful and right; he shall surely live.* "None of the sins they have committed will be counted against them. They have done what is just and right. They will surely live."
- 17 *Yet the children of thy people say, The way of the Lord is not equal: but as for them, their way is not equal.* "Yet your people say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' But it is their way that is not fair."
- 18 *When the righteous turneth from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, he shall even die thereby.* "If the righteous turn from their righteousness and do evil, they will die for it."
- 19 *But if the wicked turn from his wickedness, and do that which is lawful and right, he shall live thereby.* "And if the wicked turn away from their wickedness and do what is just and right, they will live by doing so."
- 20 *Yet ye say, The way of the Lord is not equal. O ye house of Israel, I will judge you every one after his ways.* "Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' I will judge each of you according to your own ways, house of Israel."
- 21 *And it came to pass in the twelfth year of our captivity, in the tenth month, in the fifth day of the month, that one that had escaped out of Jerusalem came unto me, saying, The city is smitten.* In the twelfth year of our exile, on the fifth day of the tenth month, a man who had escaped from Jerusalem came to me and said, "The city has fallen!"
- 22 *Now the hand of the LORD was upon me in the evening, afore he that was escaped came; and had opened my mouth, until he came to me in the morning; and my mouth was opened, and I was no more dumb.* Now the evening before the man arrived, the hand of the LORD had been on me. He opened my mouth before the man came to me in the morning. My mouth was opened and I was silent no longer.

- 23 *Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 24 *Son of man, they that inhabit those wastes of the land of Israel speak, saying, Abraham was one, and he inherited the land: but we are many; the land is given us for inheritance.* "Son of man, the people living in those ruins in the land of Israel are saying, 'Abraham was only one man, yet he possessed the land. But we are many. Surely the land has been given to us as our possession.'"
- 25 *Wherefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Ye eat with the blood, and lift up your eyes toward your idols, and shed blood: and shall ye possess the land?* "Therefore say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: You eat meat with the blood still in it, You look to Your idols, and You shed blood. Should You then possess the land?"
- 26 *Ye stand upon your sword, ye work abomination, and ye defile every one his neighbour's wife: and shall ye possess the land?* "You rely on Your sword, You do detestable things, and each of You defiles His neighbor's wife. Should You then possess the land?"
- 27 *Say thou thus unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; As I live, surely they that are in the wastes shall fall by the sword, and him that is in the open field will I give to the beasts to be devoured, and they that be in the forts and in the caves shall die of the pestilence.* "Say this to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: As surely as I live, those in the ruins will fall by the sword, those in the open field I will give to the wild animals to be devoured, and those in strongholds and caves will die of plague."
- 28 *For I will lay the land most desolate, and the pomp of her strength shall cease; and the mountains of Israel shall be desolate, that none shall pass through.* "I will make the land a desolate waste, and her proud strength will come to an end. The mountains of Israel will become so desolate that no one will cross them."
- 29 *Then shall they know that I am the LORD, when I have laid the land most desolate because of all their abominations which they have committed.* "Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have made the land a desolate waste because of all the abominations they have committed."

- 30 *Also, thou son of man, the children of thy people still are talking against thee by the walls and in the doors of the houses, and speak one to another, every one to his brother, saying, Come, I pray you, and hear what is the word that cometh forth from the LORD.* "As for You, Son of man, Your people are talking together about You by the walls and at the doors of the houses. They say to one another, 'Come and hear the message that has come from the LORD.'"
- 31 *And they come unto thee as the people cometh, and they sit before thee as my people, and they hear thy words, but they will not do them: for with their mouth they shew much love, but their heart goeth after their covetousness.* "My people come to You, as they usually do, and sit before You to hear Your words, but they do not put them into practice. Their mouths speak of love, but their hearts are greedy for unjust gain."
- 32 *And, lo, thou art unto them as a very lovely song of one that hath a pleasant voice, and can play well on an instrument: for they hear thy words, but they do them not.* "Indeed, to them You are nothing more than one who sings love songs with a beautiful voice and plays an instrument well, for they hear Your words but do not put them into practice."
- 33 *And when this cometh to pass, (lo, it will come,) then shall they know that a prophet hath been among them.* "When all this comes true — and it surely will — then they will know that a prophet has been among them."

Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

transgression — Crossing the line God set — deliberately breaking a specific command He gave.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

v4 — Ezek 18:13; Acts 18:6; Ezek 33:9; Jer 6:17

v6 — Ezek 3:18-20; Ezek 33:8-9; Gen 42:22; 2 Sam 4:11

v7 — Jer 26:2; Ezek 3:17-21; Ezek 2:7-8; Acts 5:20; Heb 13:17

- v8** — Acts 20:26-27; Ezek 33:6; Ezek 33:14
v11 — 1 Tim 2:4; Ezek 18:23; 2 Pet 3:9; Isa 55:6-7; Acts 3:19
v12 — Ezek 33:18-19; 2 Chr 7:14
v13 — Ezek 18:24; Heb 10:38; Ezek 18:4
v15 — Ezek 20:11; Luke 19:8
v16 — Isa 43:25; Ezek 18:22
v22 — Ezek 1:3; Ezek 3:26-27; Ezek 24:26-27
v24 — Isa 51:2; Ezek 33:27; Acts 7:5; Ezek 36:4; Luke 3:8
v31 — Matt 13:22; Ps 78:36-37; Jas 1:22-24; Isa 29:13; Luke 11:28

Chapter 34

The LORD condemns the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves instead of the flock, leaving the sheep scattered and prey to wild beasts. He declares He Himself will search for His sheep, gather them, and feed them on the mountains of Israel. He will set one shepherd over them — His servant David — and make a covenant of peace with them.

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| <p>1 <i>And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD came to me:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel, prophesy, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD unto the shepherds; Woe be to the shepherds of Israel that do feed themselves! should not the shepherds feed the flocks?</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy and say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says to the shepherds: How terrible it will be for the shepherds of Israel who only take care of themselves! Should not shepherds take care of the flock?"</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Ye eat the fat, and ye clothe you with the wool, ye kill them that are fed: but ye feed not the flock.</i></p> | <p>"You eat the curds, clothe yourselves with the wool, and slaughter the choice animals, but You do not take care of the flock."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The diseased have ye not strengthened, neither have ye healed that which was sick, neither have ye bound up that which was broken, neither have ye brought again that which was driven away, neither have ye sought that which was lost; but with force and with cruelty have ye ruled them.</i></p> | <p>"You have not strengthened the weak or healed the sick or bound up the injured. You have not brought back the strays or searched for the lost. You have ruled them harshly and brutally."</p> |

- 5 *And they were scattered, because there is no shepherd: and they became meat to all the beasts of the field, when they were scattered.* "So they were scattered because there was no shepherd. When they were scattered, they became food for all the wild animals."
- 6 *My sheep wandered through all the mountains, and upon every high hill: yea, my flock was scattered upon all the face of the earth, and none did search or seek after them.* "My sheep wandered over all the mountains and on every high hill. They were scattered over the whole earth, and no one searched or looked for them."
- 7 *Therefore, ye shepherds, hear the word of the LORD;* "Therefore, You shepherds, hear the word of the LORD:"
- 8 *As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely because my flock became a prey, and my flock became meat to every beast of the field, because there was no shepherd, neither did my shepherds search for my flock, but the shepherds fed themselves, and fed not my flock;* "As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, because My flock lacks a shepherd and so has been plundered and has become food for all the wild animals — and because My shepherds did not search for My flock but cared for themselves rather than for My flock —"
- 9 *Therefore, O ye shepherds, hear the word of the LORD;* "therefore, You shepherds, hear the word of the LORD:"
- 10 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against the shepherds; and I will require my flock at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the flock; neither shall the shepherds feed themselves any more; for I will deliver my flock from their mouth, that they may not be meat for them.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against the shepherds and will hold them accountable for My flock. I will remove them from tending the flock so that the shepherds can no longer feed themselves. I will rescue My flock from their mouths, and it will no longer be food for them."
- 11 *For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I, even I, will both search my sheep, and seek them out.* "For this is what the Lord GOD says: I Myself will search for My sheep and look after them."

- 12 *As a shepherd seeketh out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered; so will I seek out my sheep, and will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day.* "As a shepherd looks after His scattered flock when He is with them, so will I look after My sheep. I will rescue them from all the places where they were scattered on a day of clouds and darkness."
- 13 *And I will bring them out from the people, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them to their own land, and feed them upon the mountains of Israel by the rivers, and in all the inhabited places of the country.* "I will bring them out from the nations and gather them from the countries, and I will bring them into their own land. I will pasture them on the mountains of Israel, in the ravines and in all the settlements in the land."
- 14 *I will feed them in a good pasture, and upon the high mountains of Israel shall their fold be: there shall they lie in a good fold, and in a fat pasture shall they feed upon the mountains of Israel.* "I will tend them in good pasture, and the mountain heights of Israel will be their grazing land. There they will lie down in good grazing land, and there they will feed in rich pasture on the mountains of Israel."
- 15 *I will feed my flock, and I will cause them to lie down, saith the Lord GOD.* "I Myself will tend My sheep and have them lie down, declares the Lord GOD."
- 16 *I will seek that which was lost, and bring again that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick: but I will destroy the fat and the strong; I will feed them with judgment.* "I will search for the lost and bring back the strays. I will bind up the injured and strengthen the weak, but the sleek and the strong I will destroy. I will shepherd the flock with justice."
- 17 *And as for you, O my flock, thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I judge between cattle and cattle, between the rams and the he goats.* "As for You, My flock, this is what the Lord GOD says: I will judge between one sheep and another — between rams and goats."

- 18 *Seemeth it a small thing unto you to have eaten up the good pasture, but ye must tread down with your feet the residue of your pastures? and to have drunk of the deep waters, but ye must foul the residue with your feet?* "Is it not enough for You to feed on the good pasture? Must You also trample the rest of Your pasture with Your feet? Is it not enough for You to drink clear water? Must You also muddy the rest with Your feet?"
- 19 *And as for my flock, they eat that which ye have trodden with your feet; and they drink that which ye have fouled with your feet.* "Must My flock feed on what You have trampled and drink what You have muddied with Your feet?"
- 20 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD unto them; Behold, I, even I, will judge between the fat cattle and between the lean cattle.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says to them: I Myself will judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep."
- 21 *Because ye have thrust with side and with shoulder, and pushed all the diseased with your horns, till ye have scattered them abroad;* "Because You shove with flank and shoulder, butting all the weak sheep with Your horns until You have driven them away —"
- 22 *Therefore will I save my flock, and they shall no more be a prey; and I will judge between cattle and cattle.* "I will save My flock, and they will no longer be plundered. I will judge between one sheep and another."
- 23 *And I will set up one shepherd over them, and he shall feed them, even my servant David; he shall feed them, and he shall be their shepherd.* "I will place over them one shepherd, My servant David, and he will tend them. He will tend them and be their shepherd."
- 24 *And I the LORD will be their God, and my servant David a prince among them; I the LORD have spoken it.* "I the LORD will be their God, and My servant David will be prince among them. I the LORD have spoken."
- 25 *And I will make with them a covenant of peace, and will cause the evil beasts to cease out of the land: and they shall dwell safely in the wilderness, and sleep in the woods.* "I will make a covenant of peace with them and rid the land of savage beasts so that they may live in the desert and sleep in the forests in safety."

- 26 *And I will make them and the places round about my hill a blessing; and I will cause the shower to come down in his season; there shall be showers of blessing.* "I will make them and the places surrounding My hill a blessing. I will send down showers in season. There will be showers of blessing."
- 27 *And the tree of the field shall yield her fruit, and the earth shall yield her increase, and they shall be safe in their land, and shall know that I am the LORD, when I have broken the bands of their yoke, and delivered them out of the hand of those that served themselves of them.* "The trees of the field will yield their fruit and the ground will yield its crops. The people will be secure in their land. They will know that I am the LORD when I break the bars of their yoke and rescue them from the hands of those who enslaved them."
- 28 *And they shall no more be a prey to the heathen, neither shall the beast of the land devour them; but they shall dwell safely, and none shall make them afraid.* "They will no longer be plundered by the heathen, nor will wild animals devour them. They will live in safety, and no one will make them afraid."
- 29 *And I will raise up for them a plant of renown, and they shall be no more consumed with hunger in the land, neither bear the shame of the heathen any more.* "I will provide for them a land renowned for its crops, and they will no longer be victims of famine in the land or bear the scorn of the heathen."
- 30 *Then shall they know that I the LORD their God am with them, and that they, even the house of Israel, are my people, saith the Lord GOD.* "Then they will know that I the LORD their God am with them and that they, the house of Israel, are My people, declares the Lord GOD."
- 31 *And ye my flock, the flock of my pasture, are men, and I am your God, saith the Lord GOD.* "You My sheep, the sheep of My pasture, are people, and I am Your God, declares the Lord GOD."

Words in this chapter:

covenant — A binding agreement — God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 23:1; Jer 3:15; Isa 40:11; Luke 20:46-47; Ezek 34:8-10
 v4 — Matt 18:12-13; Ezek 34:16; Matt 9:36; Matt 10:6; Zech 11:15-16
 v11 — John 10:16; Luke 19:10; Jer 23:3; Isa 40:10-11; Jer 31:8
 v12 — John 10:11-12; Isa 40:11; Luke 19:10; Luke 15:4-6; Ezek 30:3
 v13 — Ezek 28:25-26; Ezek 11:17; Isa 11:11-16; Zeph 3:19-20; Ps 106:47
 v16 — Luke 19:10; Ezek 34:4; Ezek 34:11; Isa 49:26; Luke 5:31-32
 v23 — Jer 30:9; Ezek 37:24-25; Isa 40:11; Hos 3:5; John 10:11
 v25 — Ezek 37:26; Isa 11:6-9; Lev 26:6; Jer 23:6; Ezek 34:28
 v26 — Deut 28:12; Isa 44:3; Lev 26:4; Ps 68:9; Gen 12:2
 v27 — Jer 30:8; Lev 26:13; Lev 26:4; Isa 52:2-3; Ps 92:12-14
 v30 — Ezek 37:27; Ezek 34:24; Ezek 14:11; Ps 46:7; Ps 46:11
 v31 — Ps 100:3; John 10:16; Ezek 36:38; Ps 78:52; Ps 80:1

Chapter 35

The LORD pronounces judgment against Mount Seir — Edom — because of her perpetual hatred against Israel and her desire to possess both nations' lands. Because she rejoiced when Israel's inheritance was desolate, the LORD will make her a perpetual desolation.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,</i> | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | <i>Son of man, set thy face against mount Seir, and prophesy against it,</i> | "Son of man, set Your face against Mount Seir. Prophecy against it." |
| 3 | <i>And say unto it, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O mount Seir, I am against thee, and I will stretch out mine hand against thee, and I will make thee most desolate.</i> | "Say to it: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Mount Seir. I will stretch out My hand against You and make You a desolate waste." |
| 4 | <i>I will lay thy cities waste, and thou shalt be desolate, and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.</i> | "I will turn Your towns into ruins and You will be desolate. Then You will know that I am the LORD." |
| 5 | <i>Because thou hast had a perpetual hatred, and hast shed the blood of the children of Israel by the force of the sword in the time of their calamity, in the time that their iniquity had an end:</i> | "Because You harbored an ancient hostility and delivered the Israelites over to the sword at the time of their calamity, the time their punishment reached its climax —" |

- 6 *Therefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will prepare thee unto blood, and blood shall pursue thee: sith thou hast not hated blood, even blood shall pursue thee.* "therefore, as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will give You over to bloodshed and it will pursue You. Since You did not hate bloodshed, bloodshed will pursue You."
- 7 *Thus will I make mount Seir most desolate, and cut off from it him that passeth by and him that returneth.* "I will make Mount Seir a desolate waste and cut off from it all who come and go."
- 8 *And I will fill his mountains with his slain men: in thy hills, and in thy valleys, and in all thy rivers, shall they fall that are slain with the sword.* "I will fill Your mountains with the slain. Those killed by the sword will fall on Your hills, in Your valleys, and in all Your ravines."
- 9 *I will make thee perpetual desolations, and thy cities shall not return: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will make You desolate forever and Your towns will not be inhabited. Then You will know that I am the LORD."
- 10 *Because thou hast said, These two nations and these two countries shall be mine, and we will possess it; whereas the LORD was there:* "Because You said, 'These two nations and countries will be ours and we will take possession of them' — even though I the LORD was there —"
- 11 *Therefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will even do according to thine anger, and according to thine envy which thou hast used out of thy hatred against them; and I will make myself known among them, when I have judged thee.* "therefore, as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will treat You in accordance with the anger and jealousy You showed in Your hatred of them. I will make Myself known among them when I judge You."
- 12 *And thou shalt know that I am the LORD, and that I have heard all thy blasphemies which thou hast spoken against the mountains of Israel, saying, They are laid desolate, they are given us to consume.* "Then You will know that I the LORD have heard all the contemptible things You have said against the mountains of Israel. You said, 'They have been laid waste and have been given over to us to devour.'"

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| <p>13 <i>Thus with your mouth ye have boasted against me, and have multiplied your words against me: I have heard them.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; When the whole earth rejoiceth, I will make thee desolate.</i></p> <p>15 <i>As thou didst rejoice at the inheritance of the house of Israel, because it was desolate, so will I do unto thee: thou shalt be desolate, O mount Seir, and all Idumea, even all of it: and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"You boasted against Me and spoke against Me without restraint. I heard it."</p> <p>"This is what the Lord GOD says: While the whole earth rejoices, I will make You desolate."</p> <p>"Because You rejoiced when the inheritance of the house of Israel was made desolate, that is how I will treat You. You will be desolate, Mount Seir, You and all of Edom. Then they will know that I am the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v4 — Ezek 35:9

v5 — Ps 137:7; Obad 1:10-16; Amos 1:11

v8 — Ezek 31:12

v10 — Ezek 36:5; Ps 83:4-12; Ezek 48:35

Chapter 36

The LORD promises to restore the mountains of Israel, not for Israel's sake but for His holy name which they profaned among the nations. He will sprinkle clean water on them, give them a new heart and a new spirit, put His Spirit within them, and cause them to walk in His statutes.

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| <p>1 <i>Also, thou son of man, prophesy unto the mountains of Israel, and say, Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD:</i></p> | <p>"Son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel and say: Mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD."</p> |
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- 2 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because the enemy hath said against you, Aha, even the ancient high places are ours in possession:* "This is what the Lord GOD says: The enemy said of you, 'Aha! The ancient heights have become our possession.'"
- 3 *Therefore prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because they have made you desolate, and swallowed you up on every side, that ye might be a possession unto the residue of the heathen, and ye are taken up in the lips of talkers, and are an infamy of the people:* "Therefore prophesy and say: This is what the Lord GOD says: Because they ravaged and hounded You from every side so that You became the possession of the rest of the heathen and the object of people's gossip and slander —"
- 4 *Therefore, ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, to the desolate wastes, and to the cities that are forsaken, which became a prey and derision to the residue of the heathen that are round about;* "therefore, mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD. This is what the Lord GOD says to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and valleys, to the desolate ruins and the deserted towns that have been plundered and ridiculed by the rest of the heathen around you —"
- 5 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Surely in the fire of my jealousy have I spoken against the residue of the heathen, and against all Idumea, which have appointed my land into their possession with the joy of all their heart, with despiteful minds, to cast it out for a prey.* "this is what the Lord GOD says: In My burning zeal I have spoken against the rest of the heathen, and against all Edom, for with wholehearted joy and spiteful minds they took My land as their possession so that they might plunder its pastureland."

- 6 *Prophesy therefore concerning the land of Israel, and say unto the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I have spoken in my jealousy and in my fury, because ye have borne the shame of the heathen:* "Therefore prophesy concerning the land of Israel and say to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and valleys: This is what the Lord GOD says: I speak in My jealous wrath because You have suffered the scorn of the heathen."
- 7 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I have lifted up mine hand, Surely the heathen that are about you, they shall bear their shame.* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I swear with uplifted hand that the heathen around you will also suffer scorn."
- 8 *But ye, O mountains of Israel, ye shall shoot forth your branches, and yield your fruit to my people of Israel; for they are at hand to come.* "But You, mountains of Israel, will produce branches and fruit for My people Israel, for they will soon come home."
- 9 *For, behold, I am for you, and I will turn unto you, and ye shall be tilled and sown:* "I am concerned for You and will look on You with favor. You will be plowed and sown."
- 10 *And I will multiply men upon you, all the house of Israel, even all of it: and the cities shall be inhabited, and the wastes shall be builded:* "I will multiply the number of people on You — even the whole house of Israel. The towns will be inhabited and the ruins rebuilt."
- 11 *And I will multiply upon you man and beast; and they shall increase and bring fruit: and I will settle you after your old estates, and will do better unto you than at your beginnings: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will increase the number of people and animals living on You, and they will be fruitful and become numerous. I will settle people on You as in the past and will make You prosper more than before. Then You will know that I am the LORD."
- 12 *Yea, I will cause men to walk upon you, even my people Israel; and they shall possess thee, and thou shalt be their inheritance, and thou shalt no more henceforth bereave them of men.* "I will cause people — My people Israel — to live on You. They will possess You, and You will be their inheritance. You will never again deprive them of their children."

- 13 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because they say unto you, Thou land devourest up men, and hast bereaved thy nations;* "This is what the Lord GOD says: Because people say to You, 'You devour men and bereave Your nation of its children' —"
- 14 *Therefore thou shalt devour men no more, neither bereave thy nations any more, saith the Lord GOD.* "therefore You will no longer devour men or make Your nation childless, declares the Lord GOD."
- 15 *Neither will I cause men to hear in thee the shame of the heathen any more, neither shalt thou bear the reproach of the people any more, neither shalt thou cause thy nations to fall any more, saith the Lord GOD.* "No longer will I make You hear the taunts of the heathen. No longer will you suffer the scorn of the peoples or cause Your nation to fall, declares the Lord GOD."
- 16 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 17 *Son of man, when the house of Israel dwelt in their own land, they defiled it by their own way and by their doings: their way was before me as the uncleanness of a removed woman.* "Son of man, when the house of Israel was living in their own land, they defiled it by their conduct and their actions. Their conduct was like a woman's monthly uncleanness in My sight."
- 18 *Wherefore I poured my fury upon them for the blood that they had shed upon the land, and for their idols wherewith they had polluted it:* "So I poured out My wrath on them because they had shed blood in the land and because they had defiled it with their idols."
- 19 *And I scattered them among the heathen, and they were dispersed through the countries: according to their way and according to their doings I judged them.* "I dispersed them among the heathen, and they were scattered through the countries. I judged them according to their conduct and their actions."

- 20 *And when they entered unto the heathen, whither they went, they profaned my holy name, when they said to them, These are the people of the LORD, and are gone forth out of his land.* "And wherever they went among the heathen they profaned My holy name, for it was said of them, "These are the LORD's people, and yet they had to leave His land."
- 21 *But I had pity for mine holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the heathen, whither they went.* "I had concern for My holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the heathen where they had gone."
- 22 *Therefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I do not this for your sakes, O house of Israel, but for mine holy name's sake, which ye have profaned among the heathen, whither ye went.* "Therefore say to the house of Israel: This is what the Lord GOD says: It is not for Your sake, house of Israel, that I am going to do these things, but for the sake of My holy name, which You have profaned among the heathen where you have gone."
- 23 *And I will sanctify my great name, which was profaned among the heathen, which ye have profaned in the midst of them; and the heathen shall know that I am the LORD, saith the Lord GOD, when I shall be sanctified in you before their eyes.* "I will show the holiness of My great name, which has been profaned among the heathen — the name you have profaned among them. Then the heathen will know that I am the LORD, declares the Lord GOD, when I am proved holy through You before their eyes."
- 24 *For I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land.* "For I will take You out of the heathen. I will gather you from all the countries and bring You back into Your own land."
- 25 *Then will I sprinkle clean water upon you, and ye shall be clean: from all your filthiness, and from all your idols, will I cleanse you.* "I will sprinkle clean water on You, and You will be clean. I will cleanse You from all Your impurities and from all Your idols."

- 26 *A new heart also will I give you, and a new spirit will I put within you: and I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you an heart of flesh.* "I will give You a new heart and put a new spirit in You. I will remove from You Your heart of stone and give You a heart of flesh."
- 27 *And I will put my spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes, and ye shall keep my judgments, and do them.* "And I will put My Spirit in You and move You to follow My decrees and be careful to keep My laws."
- 28 *And ye shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers; and ye shall be my people, and I will be your God.* "Then You will live in the land I gave Your ancestors. You will be My people, and I will be Your God."
- 29 *I will also save you from all your uncleannesses: and I will call for the corn, and will increase it, and lay no famine upon you.* "I will save You from all Your uncleanness. I will call for the grain and make it plentiful and will not bring famine on You."
- 30 *And I will multiply the fruit of the tree, and the increase of the field, that ye shall receive no more reproach of famine among the heathen.* "I will increase the fruit of the trees and the crops of the field, so that You will no longer suffer disgrace among the heathen because of famine."
- 31 *Then shall ye remember your own evil ways, and your doings that were not good, and shall lothe yourselves in your own sight for your iniquities and for your abominations.* "Then You will remember Your evil ways and wicked deeds, and You will despise yourselves for Your sins and detestable practices."
- 32 *Not for your sakes do I this, saith the Lord GOD, be it known unto you: be ashamed and confounded for your own ways, O house of Israel.* "I want You to know that I am not doing this for Your sake, declares the Lord GOD. Be ashamed and disgraced for Your conduct, house of Israel!"
- 33 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day that I shall have cleansed you from all your iniquities I will also cause you to dwell in the cities, and the wastes shall be builded.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: On the day I cleanse You from all Your sins, I will resettle Your towns, and the ruins will be rebuilt."

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| 34 | <i>And the desolate land shall be tilled, whereas it lay desolate in the sight of all that passed by.</i> | "The desolate land will be cultivated instead of lying desolate in the sight of all who pass through it." |
| 35 | <i>And they shall say, This land that was desolate is become like the garden of Eden; and the waste and desolate and ruined cities are become fenced, and are inhabited.</i> | "They will say, 'This land that was laid waste has become like the garden of Eden. The cities that were lying in ruins, desolate and destroyed, are now fortified and inhabited.'" |
| 36 | <i>Then the heathen that are left round about you shall know that I the LORD build the ruined places, and plant that that was desolate: I the LORD have spoken it, and I will do it.</i> | "Then the heathen around you that remain will know that I the LORD have rebuilt what was destroyed and replanted what was desolate. I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it." |
| 37 | <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will yet for this be enquired of by the house of Israel, to do it for them; I will increase them with men like a flock.</i> | "This is what the Lord GOD says: Once again I will let the house of Israel ask Me to do this for them. I will increase their numbers like a flock." |
| 38 | <i>As the holy flock, as the flock of Jerusalem in her solemn feasts; so shall the waste cities be filled with flocks of men: and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i> | "Like flocks of sheep for offerings, like the flocks at Jerusalem during her appointed festivals, so will the ruined cities be filled with flocks of people. Then they will know that I am the LORD." |

Words in this chapter:

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Cross-References:

v11 — Jer 33:12; Jer 23:5-8; Mic 7:14; Ezek 37:13; Jer 31:27

v17 — Jer 2:7; Num 35:33-34; Mic 2:10

v22 — Ps 106:8; Ezek 36:32; Ps 115:1-2; Deut 7:7-8; Deut 9:5-7

v23 — Ezek 20:41; Isa 5:16; Ezek 39:7; 1 Pet 2:9; Ezek 39:28

v24 — Ezek 37:21; Ezek 34:13; Amos 9:14-15; Ps 107:2-3

v25 — Heb 10:22; John 3:5; Jer 33:8; 1 John 1:7; Titus 3:5-6

v26 — Ezek 11:19-20; Ps 51:10; 2 Cor 5:17; John 3:3-5; Deut 30:6

v27 — Titus 3:3-6; Ezek 39:29; Heb 13:21; Jer 31:33; 1 Cor 3:16

v28 — Ezek 37:27; Jer 31:33; Jer 32:38; Ezek 37:23; Ezek 11:20

v31 — Ezek 20:43; Ezek 6:9; Neh 9:26-35

v36 — Matt 24:35; Ezek 17:24; Num 23:19; Ezek 37:14; Hos 14:4-9

v37 — Heb 10:21-22; 1 John 5:14; Zech 10:9; Zech 10:6; Ezek 14:3

Chapter 37

The LORD sets Ezekiel in a valley of dry bones and commands him to prophesy to them. Breath enters the bones and they live — a vast army. The vision means Israel will be raised from the grave of exile and restored to their land. Ezekiel then joins two sticks together as a sign that Judah and Israel will become one nation under one king — the LORD's servant David.

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| 1 | <i>The hand of the LORD was upon me, and carried me out in the spirit of the LORD, and set me down in the midst of the valley which was full of bones,</i> | <i>The hand of the LORD was on me, and He brought me out by the Spirit of the LORD and set me in the middle of a valley. It was full of bones.</i> |
| 2 | <i>And caused me to pass by them round about: and, behold, there were very many in the open valley; and, lo, they were very dry.</i> | <i>He led me back and forth among them, and I saw a great many bones on the floor of the valley. The bones were very dry.</i> |
| 3 | <i>And he said unto me, Son of man, can these bones live? And I answered, O Lord GOD, thou knowest.</i> | <i>He asked me, "Son of man, can these bones live?" I said, "Sovereign Lord GOD, You alone know."</i> |
| 4 | <i>Again he said unto me, Prophesy upon these bones, and say unto them, O ye dry bones, hear the word of the LORD.</i> | <i>Then He said to me, "Prophesy to these bones and say to them, 'Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!'"</i> |
| 5 | <i>Thus saith the Lord GOD unto these bones; Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and ye shall live:</i> | <i>"This is what the Lord GOD says to these bones: I will make breath enter You, and You will come to life."</i> |
| 6 | <i>And I will lay sinews upon you, and will bring up flesh upon you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and ye shall live; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.</i> | <i>"I will attach tendons to You and make flesh come on You and cover You with skin. I will put breath in You, and You will come to life. Then You will know that I am the LORD."</i> |

- 7 *So I prophesied as I was commanded: and as I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold a shaking, and the bones came together, bone to his bone.* So I prophesied as I was commanded. As I was prophesying, there was a noise, a rattling sound, and the bones came together, bone to bone.
- 8 *And when I beheld, lo, the sinews and the flesh came up upon them, and the skin covered them above: but there was no breath in them.* I looked, and tendons and flesh appeared on them and skin covered them, but there was no breath in them.
- 9 *Then said he unto me, Prophesy unto the wind, prophesy, son of man, and say to the wind, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe upon these slain, that they may live.* Then He said to me, "Prophesy to the breath. Prophesy, Son of man, and say to it: This is what the Lord GOD says: Come, breath, from the four winds and breathe into these slain, that they may live."
- 10 *So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up upon their feet, an exceeding great army.* So I prophesied as He commanded me, and breath entered them. They came to life and stood up on their feet — a vast army.
- 11 *Then he said unto me, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel: behold, they say, Our bones are dried, and our hope is lost: we are cut off for our parts.* Then He said to me, "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. They say, 'Our bones are dried up and our hope is gone. We are cut off.'"
- 12 *Therefore prophesy and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O my people, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, and bring you into the land of Israel.* "Therefore prophesy and say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: My people, I am going to open Your graves and bring You up from them. I will bring You back to the land of Israel."
- 13 *And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I have opened your graves, O my people, and brought you up out of your graves,* "Then You, My people, will know that I am the LORD, when I open Your graves and bring You up from them."

- 14 *And shall put my spirit in you, and ye shall live, and I shall place you in your own land: then shall ye know that I the LORD have spoken it, and performed it, saith the LORD.* "I will put My Spirit in You and You will live, and I will settle You in Your own land. Then You will know that I the LORD have spoken, and I have done it, declares the LORD."
- 15 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,* The word of the LORD came to me:
- 16 *Moreover, thou son of man, take thee one stick, and write upon it, For Judah, and for the children of Israel his companions: then take another stick, and write upon it, For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all the house of Israel his companions:* "Son of man, take a stick of wood and write on it, 'Belonging to Judah and the Israelites associated with him.' Then take another stick of wood and write on it, 'Belonging to Joseph — that is, to Ephraim — and all the house of Israel associated with him.'"
- 17 *And join them one to another into one stick; and they shall become one in thine hand.* "Join them together into one stick so that they will become one in your hand."
- 18 *And when the children of thy people shall speak unto thee, saying, Wilt thou not shew us what thou meanest by these?* "When your people ask you, 'Won't you tell us what you mean by this?' —"
- 19 *Say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel his fellows, and will put them with him, even with the stick of Judah, and make them one stick, and they shall be one in mine hand.* "say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am going to take the stick of Joseph — which is in Ephraim's hand — and of the Israelite tribes associated with Him, and join it to Judah's stick. I will make them into a single stick of wood. They will be one in My hand."
- 20 *And the sticks whereon thou writest shall be in thine hand before their eyes.* "Hold before their eyes the sticks You have written on."

- 21 *And say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will take the children of Israel from among the heathen, whither they be gone, and will gather them on every side, and bring them into their own land:* "Say to them: This is what the Lord GOD says: I will take the Israelites out of the heathen where they have gone. I will gather them from all around and bring them back into their own land."
- 22 *And I will make them one nation in the land upon the mountains of Israel; and one king shall be king to them all: and they shall be no more two nations, neither shall they be divided into two kingdoms any more at all:* "I will make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel. There will be one king over all of them and they will never again be two nations or be divided into two kingdoms."
- 23 *Neither shall they defile themselves any more with their idols, nor with their detestable things, nor with any of their transgressions: but I will save them out of all their dwellingplaces, wherein they have sinned, and will cleanse them: so shall they be my people, and I will be their God.* "They will no longer defile themselves with their idols and vile images or with any of their offenses, for I will save them from all their sinful backsliding, and I will cleanse them. They will be My people, and I will be their God."
- 24 *And David my servant shall be king over them; and they all shall have one shepherd: they shall also walk in my judgments, and observe my statutes, and do them.* "My servant David will be king over them, and they will all have one shepherd. They will follow My laws and be careful to keep My decrees."
- 25 *And they shall dwell in the land that I have given unto Jacob my servant, wherein your fathers have dwelt; and they shall dwell therein, even they, and their children, and their children's children for ever: and my servant David shall be their prince for ever.* "They will live in the land I gave to My servant Jacob, the land where your ancestors lived. They and their children and their children's children will live there forever, and David My servant will be their prince forever."

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| <p>26 <i>Moreover I will make a covenant of peace with them; it shall be an everlasting covenant with them: and I will place them, and multiply them, and will set my sanctuary in the midst of them for evermore.</i></p> <p>27 <i>My tabernacle also shall be with them: yea, I will be their God, and they shall be my people.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And the heathen shall know that I the LORD do sanctify Israel, when my sanctuary shall be in the midst of them for evermore.</i></p> | <p>"I will make a covenant of peace with them. It will be an everlasting covenant. I will establish them and increase their numbers, and I will put My sanctuary among them forever."</p> <p>"My tabernacle shall be with them. I will be their God, and they will be My people."</p> <p>"Then the heathen will know that I the LORD make Israel holy, when My sanctuary is among them forever."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Joseph (JO-zef) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 3:22; Acts 8:39; Ezek 1:3; Ezek 33:22; Jer 7:32
- v3 — John 11:25-26; John 5:21; Deut 32:39; Rom 4:17; Heb 11:19
- v4 — John 5:25; John 5:28-29; Matt 21:21; Ezek 36:1; Jer 22:29
- v5 — Gen 2:7; Ezek 37:14; Ps 104:29-30; Ezek 37:9-10; John 20:22
- v9 — John 3:8; Song 4:16; Ezek 37:5; Ezek 37:14; Ps 104:30
- v11 — Eph 2:1; Ps 77:7-9; Ezek 39:25; Jer 31:1; Ezek 36:10
- v12 — Isa 26:19; Hos 13:14; 1 Thess 4:16; Isa 66:14; Rev 20:13
- v14 — Ezek 36:27; Joel 2:28-29; Ezek 11:19; Ezek 36:36; Ezek 39:29
- v21 — Ezek 36:24; Jer 23:8; Jer 32:37; Jer 29:14; Amos 9:14-15
- v23 — Rev 21:3-4; Ezek 36:28-29; 1 John 1:9; 1 John 1:7; Zech 13:1-2
- v24 — Ezek 34:23-24; Hos 3:5; Jer 30:9; Ezek 37:25; Ezek 36:27
- v28 — John 17:17-19; Ezek 20:12; Ex 31:13; 1 Cor 1:30; Ezek 36:23

Chapter 38

The LORD declares that in the latter days, Gog of the land of Magog — chief prince of Meshech and Tubal — will lead a vast coalition against the restored Israel. But when Gog

comes against the land, the LORD's fury will rise: He will strike with earthquake, pestilence, blood, flooding rain, great hailstones, fire, and brimstone.

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| 1 | And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying, | The word of the LORD came to me: |
| 2 | Son of man, set thy face against Gog, the land of Magog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal, and prophesy against him, | "Son of man, set Your face against Gog, of the land of Magog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal. Prophesy against Him." |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gog** (GAHG) — A name for the great end-time enemy who leads a coalition of nations against Israel. Possibly a title rather than a personal name. He leads armies from the land of Magog in the far north.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Magog** (MAY-gog) — The land from which Gog comes, described as being in the far north. In prophecy it represents the nations that will gather against Israel in the last days (also referenced in Revelation 20:8).

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| 3 | And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal: | "Say: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal." |
| 4 | And I will turn thee back, and put hooks into thy jaws, and I will bring thee forth, and all thine army, horses and horsemen, all of them clothed with all sorts of armour, even a great company with bucklers and shields, all of them handling swords: | "I will turn You around, put hooks in Your jaws and bring You out with Your whole army — your horses, Your horsemen fully armed, and a great horde with large and small shields, all of them brandishing their swords." |
| 5 | Persia, Ethiopia, and Libya with them; all of them with shield and helmet: | "Persia, Cush, and Put will be with them, all with shields and helmets." |
| 6 | Gomer, and all his bands; the house of Togarmah of the north quarters, and all his bands: and many people with thee. | "Also Gomer with all its troops, and Beth Togarmah from the far north with all its troops — the many nations with You." |

- 7 *Be thou prepared, and prepare for thyself, thou, and all thy company that are assembled unto thee, and be thou a guard unto them.* "Get ready. Be prepared — you and all Your hordes assembled around You. You be their commander."
- 8 *After many days thou shalt be visited: in the latter years thou shalt come into the land that is brought back from the sword, and is gathered out of many people, against the mountains of Israel, which have been always waste: but it is brought forth out of the nations, and they shall dwell safely all of them.* "After many days You will be called to arms. In future years You will invade a land that has recovered from war, whose people were gathered from many nations to the mountains of Israel, which had long been desolate. They had been brought out from the nations, and now all of them live in safety."
- 9 *Thou shalt ascend and come like a storm, thou shalt be like a cloud to cover the land, thou, and all thy bands, and many people with thee.* "You and all Your troops and the many nations with You will go up, advancing like a storm. You will be like a cloud covering the land."
- 10 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; It shall also come to pass, that at the same time shall things come into thy mind, and thou shalt think an evil thought:* "This is what the Lord GOD says: On that day thoughts will come into Your mind and You will devise an evil scheme."
- 11 *And thou shalt say, I will go up to the land of unwalled villages; I will go to them that are at rest, that dwell safely, all of them dwelling without walls, and having neither bars nor gates,* "You will say, 'I will invade a land of unwalled villages. I will attack a peaceful and unsuspecting people — all of them living without walls and without gates and bars.'"
- 12 *To take a spoil, and to take a prey; to turn thine hand upon the desolate places that are now inhabited, and upon the people that are gathered out of the nations, which have gotten cattle and goods, that dwell in the midst of the land.* "I will plunder and loot and turn my hand against the resettled ruins and the people gathered from the nations, rich in livestock and goods, living at the center of the land."

- 13 *Sheba, and Dedan, and the merchants of Tarshish, with all the young lions thereof, shall say unto thee, Art thou come to take a spoil? hast thou gathered thy company to take a prey? to carry away silver and gold, to take away cattle and goods, to take great spoil?* "Sheba and Dedan and the merchants of Tarshish and all her villages will say to You, 'Have You come to plunder? Have You gathered Your hordes to loot — to carry off silver and gold, to take away livestock and goods and to seize much plunder?'"
- 14 *Therefore, son of man, prophesy and say unto Gog, Thus saith the Lord GOD; In that day when my people of Israel dwelleth safely, shalt thou not know it?* "Therefore, Son of man, prophesy and say to Gog: This is what the Lord GOD says: In that day, when My people Israel are living in safety, will You not know it?"
- 15 *And thou shalt come from thy place out of the north parts, thou, and many people with thee, all of them riding upon horses, a great company, and a mighty army:* "You will come from Your place in the far north, You and many nations with You — all of them riding on horses — a great horde, a mighty army."
- 16 *And thou shalt come up against my people of Israel, as a cloud to cover the land; it shall be in the latter days, and I will bring thee against my land, that the heathen may know me, when I shall be sanctified in thee, O Gog, before their eyes.* "You will advance against My people Israel like a cloud that covers the land. In days to come, Gog, I will bring You against My land, so that the heathen may know Me when I am proved holy through You before their eyes."
- 17 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Art thou he of whom I have spoken in old time by my servants the prophets of Israel, which prophesied in those days many years that I would bring thee against them?* "This is what the Lord GOD says: You are the one I spoke of in former days by My servants the prophets of Israel. At that time they prophesied for years that I would bring You against them."
- 18 *And it shall come to pass at the same time when Gog shall come against the land of Israel, saith the Lord GOD, that my fury shall come up in my face.* "This is what will happen in that day: When Gog attacks the land of Israel, My hot anger will be aroused, declares the Lord GOD."

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| <p>19 <i>For in my jealousy and in the fire of my wrath have I spoken, Surely in that day there shall be a great shaking in the land of Israel;</i></p> <p>20 <i>So that the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the heaven, and the beasts of the field, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, and all the men that are upon the face of the earth, shall shake at my presence, and the mountains shall be thrown down, and the steep places shall fall, and every wall shall fall to the ground.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And I will call for a sword against him throughout all my mountains, saith the Lord GOD: every man's sword shall be against his brother.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And I will plead against him with pestilence and with blood; and I will rain upon him, and upon his bands, and upon the many people that are with him, an overflowing rain, and great hailstones, fire, and brimstone.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Thus will I magnify myself, and sanctify myself; and I will be known in the eyes of many nations, and they shall know that I am the LORD.</i></p> | <p>"In My zeal and fiery wrath I declare that at that time there shall be a great earthquake in the land of Israel."</p> <p>"The fish in the sea, the birds in the sky, the wild animals, all the creatures that move along the ground, and all the people on the face of the earth will tremble at My presence. The mountains will be overturned, the cliffs will crumble, and every wall will fall to the ground."</p> <p>"I will summon a sword against Gog on all My mountains, declares the Lord GOD. Every man's sword will be against his brother."</p> <p>"I will execute judgment on Him with plague and bloodshed. I will pour down torrents of rain, hailstones, fire, and burning sulfur on Him and on His troops and on the many nations with Him."</p> <p>"And so I will show My greatness and My holiness, and I will make Myself known in the sight of many nations. Then they will know that I am the LORD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v2 — Ezek 39:1; Ezek 27:13; Gen 10:2; Ezek 38:3

v4 — Dan 11:40; Ezek 29:4

v5 — Ezek 27:10; Gen 10:6

v6 — Gen 10:2-3; Ezek 27:14

v8 — Isa 24:22; Ezek 38:16

v9 — Isa 28:2; Jer 4:13

v10 — Mic 2:1; Ps 36:4

v15 — Ezek 39:2; Ezek 38:6

v17 — Dan 11:40-45; Ezek 38:16; Joel 3:9-14; Isa 63:1-6

v21 — Hag 2:22; Ezek 14:17; Judg 7:22

v22 — Rev 16:21; Isa 66:16; Ps 11:6

v23 — Ps 9:16; Rev 19:1-6; Ezek 38:16; Rev 15:3-4; Ezek 36:23

Chapter 39

The LORD completes the prophecy against Gog: his armies will fall on the mountains of Israel, and it will take seven months to bury the dead and seven years to burn the weapons. The LORD will display His glory among the nations, and Israel will know that He is the LORD their God from that day forward.

- ¹ *Therefore, thou son of man, prophesy against Gog, and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal:*

"Son of man, prophesy against Gog and say: This is what the Lord GOD says: I am against You, Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal."
- ² *And I will turn thee back, and leave but the sixth part of thee, and will cause thee to come up from the north parts, and will bring thee upon the mountains of Israel:*

"I will turn You around and drag You along. I will bring You from the far north and send You against the mountains of Israel."
- ³ *And I will smite thy bow out of thy left hand, and will cause thine arrows to fall out of thy right hand.*

"Then I will strike Your bow from Your left hand and make Your arrows drop from Your right hand."
- ⁴ *Thou shalt fall upon the mountains of Israel, thou, and all thy bands, and the people that is with thee: I will give thee unto the ravenous birds of every sort, and to the beasts of the field to be devoured.*

"On the mountains of Israel You will fall — you and all Your troops and the nations with you. I will give you as food to all kinds of carrion birds and to the wild animals."

- 5 *Thou shalt fall upon the open field: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.* "You will fall in the open field, for I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD."
- 6 *And I will send a fire on Magog, and among them that dwell carelessly in the isles: and they shall know that I am the LORD.* "I will send fire on Magog and on those who live in safety in the coastlands, and they will know that I am the LORD."
- 7 *So will I make my holy name known in the midst of my people Israel; and I will not let them pollute my holy name any more: and the heathen shall know that I am the LORD, the Holy One in Israel.* "I will make My holy name known among My people Israel. I will no longer let My holy name be profaned. Then the heathen will know that I the LORD am the Holy One in Israel."
- 8 *Behold, it is come, and it is done, saith the Lord GOD; this is the day whereof I have spoken.* "It is coming! It will surely take place, declares the Lord GOD. This is the day I have spoken of."
- 9 *And they that dwell in the cities of Israel shall go forth, and shall set on fire and burn the weapons, both the shields and the bucklers, the bows and the arrows, and the handstaves, and the spears, and they shall burn them with fire seven years:* "Then those who live in the towns of Israel will go out and use the weapons for fuel — the small shields and large shields, the bows and arrows, the clubs and spears. For seven years they will use them for fuel."
- 10 *So that they shall take no wood out of the field, neither cut down any out of the forests; for they shall burn the weapons with fire: and they shall plunder those that plundered them, and rob those that robbed them, saith the Lord GOD.* "They will not need to gather wood from the fields or cut it from the forests, because they will use the weapons for fuel. And they will plunder those who plundered them and loot those who looted them, declares the Lord GOD."

- 11 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will give unto Gog a place there of graves in Israel, the valley of the passengers on the east of the sea: and it shall stop the noses of the passengers: and there shall they bury Gog and all his multitude: and they shall call it The valley of Hamongog.* "On that day I will give Gog a burial place in Israel — in the valley of those who travel east toward the sea. It will block the way of travelers, because Gog and all His hordes will be buried there. It will be called the Valley of Hamon Gog."
- 12 *And seven months shall the house of Israel be burying of them, that they may cleanse the land.* "For seven months the house of Israel will be burying them in order to cleanse the land."
- 13 *Yea, all the people of the land shall bury them; and it shall be to them a renown the day that I shall be glorified, saith the Lord GOD.* "All the people of the land will bury them, and the day I display My glory will be a memorable day for them, declares the Lord GOD."
- 14 *And they shall sever out men of continual employment, passing through the land to bury with the passengers those that remain upon the face of the earth, to cleanse it: after the end of seven months shall they search.* "Men will be regularly employed to cleanse the land. They will travel throughout the land, and whenever they see human bones, they will set up a marker beside them until the grave-diggers have buried them in the Valley of Hamon Gog."
- 15 *And the passengers that pass through the land, when any seeth a man's bone, then shall he set up a sign by it, till the buriers have buried it in the valley of Hamongog.* "As they travel through the land, when any of them sees a human bone, they will put up a marker beside it so that the grave-diggers may bury it in the Valley of Hamon Gog."
- 16 *And also the name of the city shall be Hamonah. Thus shall they cleanse the land.* "Also a town called Hamonah will be there. And so they will cleanse the land."

- 17 *And, thou son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD; Speak unto every feathered fowl, and to every beast of the field, Assemble yourselves, and come; gather yourselves on every side to my sacrifice that I do sacrifice for you, even a great sacrifice upon the mountains of Israel, that ye may eat flesh, and drink blood.* "Son of man, this is what the Lord GOD says: Call out to every kind of bird and all the wild animals: 'Assemble and come together from all around to the sacrifice I am preparing for You — the great sacrifice on the mountains of Israel. There You will eat flesh and drink blood.'"
- 18 *Ye shall eat the flesh of the mighty, and drink the blood of the princes of the earth, of rams, of lambs, and of goats, of bullocks, all of them fatlings of Bashan.* "'You will eat the flesh of mighty men and drink the blood of the princes of the earth as though they were rams and lambs, goats and bulls — all of them fattened animals from Bashan.'"
- 19 *And ye shall eat fat till ye be full, and drink blood till ye be drunken, of my sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you.* "'At the sacrifice I am preparing for You, You will eat fat till You are glutted and drink blood till You are drunk.'"
- 20 *Thus ye shall be filled at my table with horses and chariots, with mighty men, and with all men of war, saith the Lord GOD.* "'At My table You will eat Your fill of horses and riders, mighty men and soldiers of every kind, declares the Lord GOD.'"
- 21 *And I will set my glory among the heathen, and all the heathen shall see my judgment that I have executed, and my hand that I have laid upon them.* "I will display My glory among the heathen, and all the heathen will see the punishment I inflict and the hand I lay on them."
- 22 *So the house of Israel shall know that I am the LORD their God from that day and forward.* "From that day forward the house of Israel will know that I am the LORD their God."

- 23 *And the heathen shall know that the house of Israel went into captivity for their iniquity: because they trespassed against me, therefore hid I my face from them, and gave them into the hand of their enemies: so fell they all by the sword.* "And the heathen will know that the house of Israel went into captivity for their iniquity, because they trespassed against Me. Therefore I hid My face from them and gave them into the hand of their enemies, and they all fell by the sword."
- 24 *According to their uncleanness and according to their transgressions have I done unto them, and hid my face from them.* "I dealt with them according to their uncleanness and their offenses, and I hid My face from them."
- 25 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Now will I bring again the captivity of Jacob, and have mercy upon the whole house of Israel, and will be jealous for my holy name;* "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Now will I bring again the captivity of Jacob and have mercy upon the whole house of Israel, and I will be jealous for My holy name."
- 26 *After that they have borne their shame, and all their trespasses whereby they have trespassed against me, when they dwelt safely in their land, and none made them afraid.* "After they have borne their shame and all their trespasses whereby they trespassed against Me, when they lived safely in their land with no one to make them afraid —"
- 27 *When I have brought them again from the people, and gathered them out of their enemies' lands, and am sanctified in them in the sight of many nations;* "When I have brought them back from the nations and have gathered them from the countries of their enemies, I will be proved holy through them in the sight of many nations."
- 28 *Then shall they know that I am the LORD their God, which caused them to be led into captivity among the heathen: but I have gathered them unto their own land, and have left none of them any more there.* "Then they will know that I am the LORD their God, for though I sent them into exile among the heathen, I will gather them to their own land, not leaving any behind."

29	<i>Neither will I hide my face any more from them: for I have poured out my spirit upon the house of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.</i>	"I will no longer hide My face from them, for I will pour out My Spirit on the house of Israel, declares the Lord GOD."
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Words in this chapter:

Bashan (BAY-shan) — A fertile plateau east of the Jordan and north of Gilead — known for its strong cattle; the kingdom of Og of Bashan who was defeated by Israel.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 38:2-3
- v3 — Ps 76:3
- v6 — Ezek 30:8; Amos 1:4; Ezek 30:16
- v7 — Ezek 38:23; Ezek 38:16
- v9 — Ps 46:9
- v10 — Isa 33:1
- v12 — Deut 21:23
- v13 — Ezek 28:22
- v17 — Rev 19:17-18; Zeph 1:7; Isa 34:6; Ezek 39:4; Jer 12:9
- v20 — Rev 19:18
- v25 — Ezek 34:13; Isa 27:12-13
- v29 — Joel 2:28; 1 John 3:24; Isa 32:15; Ezek 36:25-27; Zech 12:10

Chapter 40

In the twenty-fifth year of exile, the LORD brings Ezekiel in a vision to a high mountain in Israel and shows him a man with a measuring rod. The man measures the outer court, its gates — east, north, and south — and the inner court with its gates, tables for sacrifice, and chambers in meticulous detail.

1	<i>In the five and twentieth year of our captivity, in the beginning of the year, in the tenth day of the month, in the fourteenth year after that the city was smitten, in the selfsame day the hand of the LORD was upon me, and brought me thither.</i>	In the twenty-fifth year of our exile, at the beginning of the year, on the tenth day of the month — fourteen years after the city had fallen — on that very day the hand of the LORD was on me and He brought me there.
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- 2 *In the visions of God brought he me into the land of Israel, and set me upon a very high mountain, by which was as the frame of a city on the south.* In visions of God He brought me to the land of Israel and set me on a very high mountain, on whose south side were some buildings that looked like a city.
- 3 *And he brought me thither, and, behold, there was a man, whose appearance was like the appearance of brass, with a line of flax in his hand, and a measuring reed; and he stood in the gate.* He took me there, and I saw a man whose appearance was like bronze. He was standing in the gateway with a linen cord and a measuring rod in His hand.
- 4 *And the man said unto me, Son of man, behold with thine eyes, and hear with thine ears, and set thine heart upon all that I shall shew thee; for to the intent that I might shew them unto thee art thou brought hither: declare all that thou seest to the house of Israel.* The man said to me, "Son of man, look carefully and listen closely. Pay attention to everything I am going to show you, for that is why you have been brought here. Report everything you see to the house of Israel."
- 5 *And behold a wall on the outside of the house round about, and in the man's hand a measuring reed of six cubits long by the cubit and an hand breadth: so he measured the breadth of the building, one reed; and the height, one reed.* I saw a wall completely surrounding the temple area. The length of the measuring rod in the man's hand was six long cubits, each of which was a cubit and a handbreadth. He measured the wall. It was one rod thick and one rod high.
- 6 *Then came he unto the gate which looketh toward the east, and went up the stairs thereof, and measured the threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad; and the other threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad.* Then he went to the east gate and climbed its steps and measured the threshold of the gate — it was one rod deep.

- 7 *And every little chamber was one reed long, and one reed broad; and between the little chambers were five cubits; and the threshold of the gate by the porch of the gate within was one reed.* Each alcove was one rod long and one rod wide. Between the alcoves was a space of five cubits. The threshold of the gate next to the portico facing the temple was one rod deep.
- 8 *He measured also the porch of the gate within, one reed.* He measured the portico of the gateway — it was one rod deep.
- 9 *Then measured he the porch of the gate, eight cubits; and the posts thereof, two cubits; and the porch of the gate was inward.* Then he measured the portico of the gateway: eight cubits. Its jambs were two cubits. The gateway portico faced the temple.
- 10 *And the little chambers of the gate eastward were three on this side, and three on that side; they three were of one measure: and the posts had one measure on this side and on that side.* Inside the east gate were three alcoves on each side. All three were the same size, and the jambs on each side were the same size.
- 11 *And he measured the breadth of the entry of the gate, ten cubits; and the length of the gate, thirteen cubits.* Then he measured the width of the entrance of the gateway — ten cubits — and the length of the gateway — thirteen cubits.
- 12 *The space also before the little chambers was one cubit on this side, and the space was one cubit on that side: and the little chambers were six cubits on this side, and six cubits on that side.* In front of each alcove was a wall one cubit wide on each side. The alcoves were six cubits square.
- 13 *He measured then the gate from the roof of one little chamber to the roof of another: the breadth was five and twenty cubits, door against door.* Then he measured the gateway from the top of one alcove to the top of the opposite one — a width of twenty-five cubits, opening facing opening.
- 14 *He made also posts of threescore cubits, even unto the post of the court round about the gate.* He measured along the jambs all around the interior of the gateway — sixty cubits — and the court extended to the gateway all around.

- 15 *And from the face of the gate of the entrance unto the face of the porch of the inner gate were fifty cubits.* The distance from the entrance of the gateway to the far end of its portico was fifty cubits.
- 16 *And there were narrow windows to the little chambers, and to their posts within the gate round about, and likewise to the arches: and windows were round about inward: and upon each post were palm trees.* The alcoves and the recesses inside the gateway all around, and likewise the portico, had narrow windows with palm trees decorating the jambs.
- 17 *Then brought he me into the outward court, and, lo, there were chambers, and a pavement made for the court round about: thirty chambers were upon the pavement.* Then he brought me into the outer court. There I saw some rooms and a pavement that had been constructed all around the court. Thirty rooms faced the pavement.
- 18 *And the pavement by the side of the gates over against the length of the gates was the lower pavement.* The pavement alongside the gates corresponded to the length of the gates — this was the lower pavement.
- 19 *Then he measured the breadth from the forefront of the lower gate unto the forefront of the inner court without, an hundred cubits eastward and northward.* Then he measured the distance from the inside of the lower gateway to the outside of the inner court — one hundred cubits on the east side and also on the north side.
- 20 *And the gate of the outward court that looked toward the north, he measured the length thereof, and the breadth thereof.* Then he measured the length and width of the north gate of the outer court.
- 21 *And the little chambers thereof were three on this side and three on that side; and the posts thereof and the arches thereof were after the measure of the first gate: the length thereof was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.* Its alcoves — three on each side — and its jambs and its portico had the same measurements as those of the first gateway. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.

- 22 *And their windows, and their arches, and their palm trees, were after the measure of the gate that looketh toward the east; and they went up unto it by seven steps; and the arches thereof were before them.* Its windows, its portico, and its palm trees had the same measurements as those of the east gate. Seven steps led up to it with its portico facing them.
- 23 *And the gate of the inner court was over against the gate toward the north, and toward the east; and he measured from gate to gate an hundred cubits.* The inner court had a gate facing the north gate, just as it had one facing the east gate. He measured from one gate to the opposite gate — one hundred cubits.
- 24 *After that he brought me toward the south, and behold a gate toward the south: and he measured the posts thereof and the arches thereof according to these measures.* Then he led me to the south side. I saw a gate facing south. He measured its jambs and its portico, and they had the same measurements as the others.
- 25 *And there were windows in it and in the arches thereof round about, like those windows: the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.* The gateway and its portico had windows all around, like the windows of the others. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 26 *And there were seven steps to go up to it, and the arches thereof were before them: and it had palm trees, one on this side, and another on that side, upon the posts thereof.* Seven steps led up to it, with its portico facing them, and it had palm trees on its jambs, one on each side.
- 27 *And there was a gate in the inner court toward the south: and he measured from gate to gate toward the south an hundred cubits.* The inner court also had a gate facing south, and he measured from this gate to the outer gate on the south side — one hundred cubits.
- 28 *And he brought me to the inner court by the south gate: and he measured the south gate according to these measures;* Then he brought me into the inner court through the south gate. He measured the south gate, and it had the same measurements as the others.

- 29 *And the little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof, according to these measures: and there were windows in it and in the arches thereof round about: it was fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad.* Its alcoves, its jambs, and its portico had the same measurements. The gateway and its portico had windows all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 30 *And the arches round about were five and twenty cubits long, and five cubits broad.* The porticos all around were twenty-five cubits long and five cubits wide.
- 31 *And the arches thereof were toward the utter court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof: and the going up to it had eight steps.* Its portico faced the outer court. Palm trees decorated its jambs, and eight steps led up to it.
- 32 *And he brought me into the inner court toward the east: and he measured the gate according to these measures.* Then he brought me to the inner court on the east side and measured the gateway. It had the same measurements as the others.
- 33 *And the little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof, were according to these measures: and there were windows therein and in the arches thereof round about: it was fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad.* Its alcoves, its jambs, and its portico had the same measurements. The gateway and its portico had windows all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 34 *And the arches thereof were toward the outward court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof, on this side, and on that side: and the going up to it had eight steps.* Its portico faced the outer court. Palm trees decorated the jambs on either side, and eight steps led up to it.
- 35 *And he brought me to the north gate, and measured it according to these measures;* Then he brought me to the north gate and measured it. It had the same measurements as the others.

- 36 *The little chambers thereof, the posts thereof, and the arches thereof, and the windows to it round about: the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.* Its alcoves, its jambs, and its portico had windows all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 37 *And the posts thereof were toward the utter court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof, on this side, and on that side: and the going up to it had eight steps.* Its portico faced the outer court. Palm trees decorated the jambs on either side, and eight steps led up to it.
- 38 *And the chambers and the entries thereof were by the posts of the gates, where they washed the burnt offering.* A room with a doorway was by the portico in each of the inner gateways, where the burnt offerings were washed.
- 39 *And in the porch of the gate were two tables on this side, and two tables on that side, to slay thereon the burnt offering and the sin offering and the trespass offering.* In the portico of the gateway were two tables on each side, on which the burnt offerings, sin offerings, and guilt offerings were slaughtered.
- 40 *And at the side without, as one goeth up to the entry of the north gate, were two tables; and on the other side, which was at the porch of the gate, were two tables.* By the outside wall of the portico of the gateway, near the steps at the entrance of the north gateway, were two tables, and on the other side of the steps were two tables.
- 41 *Four tables were on this side, and four tables on that side, by the side of the gate; eight tables, whereupon they slew their sacrifices.* So there were four tables on one side and four on the other — eight tables in all — on which the sacrifices were slaughtered.
- 42 *And the four tables were of hewn stone for the burnt offering, of a cubit and an half long, and a cubit and an half broad, and one cubit high: whereupon also they laid the instruments wherewith they slew the burnt offering and the sacrifice.* There were also four tables of dressed stone for the burnt offerings, each a cubit and a half long, a cubit and a half wide, and a cubit high. On them were placed the utensils for slaughtering the burnt offerings and other sacrifices.

- 43 *And within were hooks, an hand broad, fastened round about: and upon the tables was the flesh of the offering.* Double hooks, each a handbreadth long, were attached to the wall all around. The tables were for the sacrificial flesh.
- 44 *And without the inner gate were the chambers of the singers in the inner court, which was at the side of the north gate; and their prospect was toward the south: one at the side of the east gate having the prospect toward the north.* Outside the inner gate, within the inner court, were two rooms — one at the side of the north gate facing south, and another at the side of the south gate facing north.
- 45 *And he said unto me, This chamber, whose prospect is toward the south, is for the priests, the keepers of the charge of the house.* He said to me, "The room facing south is for the priests who guard the temple."
- 46 *And the chamber whose prospect is toward the north is for the priests, the keepers of the charge of the altar: these are the sons of Zadok among the sons of Levi, which come near to the LORD to minister unto him.* "The room facing north is for the priests who have charge of the altar. These are the sons of Zadok, who are the only Levites who may come near the LORD to minister before Him."
- 47 *So he measured the court; an hundred cubits long, and an hundred cubits broad, foursquare; and the altar that was before the house.* Then He measured the inner court — a hundred cubits long and a hundred cubits wide, a perfect square. And the altar was in front of the temple.
- 48 *And he brought me to the porch of the house, and measured each post of the porch, five cubits on this side, and five cubits on that side: and the breadth of the gate was three cubits on this side, and three cubits on that side.* He brought me to the portico of the temple and measured the jambs of the portico — five cubits on each side. The width of the gateway was fourteen cubits, and its projecting walls were three cubits wide on each side.

- 49 *The length of the porch was twenty cubits, and the breadth eleven cubits; and he brought me by the steps whereby they went up to it: and there were pillars by the posts, one on this side, and another on that side.* The portico was twenty cubits wide and twelve cubits from front to back. It was reached by a flight of stairs, and there were pillars on each side of the jambs.

Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

trespass offering — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 33:21
- v3 — Ezek 47:3; Rev 11:1; Dan 10:5-6; Rev 1:15; Ezek 1:7
- v4 — Ezek 44:5; Ezek 2:7-8; Ezek 43:10; Jer 26:2; Matt 10:27
- v5 — Ezek 42:20
- v17 — Rev 11:2; Ezek 42:1
- v19 — Ezek 40:23; Ezek 40:27
- v22 — Ezek 40:31; Ezek 40:37
- v26 — Ezek 40:22
- v27 — Ezek 40:23
- v29 — Ezek 40:25
- v31 — Ezek 40:26; Ezek 40:22; Ezek 40:34
- v46 — Ezek 44:15; 1 Kgs 2:35; Ezek 43:19

Chapter 41

The man measures the main hall of the temple, the most holy place, the walls, side chambers, and the building behind the temple. The walls are decorated with carved cherubim and palm trees, and the temple has a wooden altar described as the table that is before the LORD.

- 1 *Afterward he brought me to the temple, and measured the posts, six cubits broad on the one side, and six cubits broad on the other side, which was the breadth of the tabernacle.* Then the man brought me to the main hall and measured the jambs — six cubits wide on each side was the width of the entrance.
- 2 *And the breadth of the door was ten cubits; and the sides of the door were five cubits on the one side, and five cubits on the other side: and he measured the length thereof, forty cubits: and the breadth, twenty cubits.* The entrance was ten cubits wide, and the projecting walls on each side of it were five cubits wide. He measured the main hall — forty cubits long and twenty cubits wide.
- 3 *Then went he inward, and measured the post of the door, two cubits; and the door, six cubits; and the breadth of the door, seven cubits.* Then he went into the inner sanctuary and measured the jambs of the entrance — two cubits thick. The entrance was six cubits wide, and the projecting walls on each side of it were seven cubits wide.
- 4 *So he measured the length thereof, twenty cubits; and the breadth, twenty cubits, before the temple: and he said unto me, This is the most holy place.* He measured the length of the inner sanctuary — twenty cubits — and its width — twenty cubits across the end of the main hall. He said to me, "This is the Most Holy Place."
- 5 *After he measured the wall of the house, six cubits; and the breadth of every side chamber, four cubits, round about the house on every side.* Then he measured the wall of the temple — six cubits thick — and the width of the side rooms all around the temple — four cubits wide.
- 6 *And the side chambers were three, one over another, and thirty in order; and they entered into the wall which was of the house for the side chambers round about, that they might have hold, but they had not hold in the wall of the house.* The side rooms were on three levels, one above another, thirty on each level. They fit into recesses in the wall of the temple all around. So the rooms were supported by the temple wall but not inserted into it.

- 7 *And there was an enlarging, and a winding about still upward to the side chambers: for the winding about of the house went still upward round about the house: therefore the breadth of the house was still upward, and so increased from the lowest chamber to the highest by the midst.* The side rooms around the temple were wider at each successive level. The structure surrounding the temple went upward in stages, so the structure widened as it went higher. A stairway went up from the lowest floor to the top floor through the middle story.
- 8 *I saw also the height of the house round about: the foundations of the side chambers were a full reed of six great cubits.* I saw that the temple had a raised base all around it — the foundations of the side rooms were a full rod, or six long cubits, high.
- 9 *The thickness of the wall, which was for the side chamber without, was five cubits: and that which was left was the place of the side chambers that were within.* The outer wall of the side rooms was five cubits thick. The open area between the side rooms of the temple
- 10 *And between the chambers was the wideness of twenty cubits round about the house on every side.* and the priests' rooms was twenty cubits wide all around the temple.
- 11 *And the doors of the side chambers were toward the place that was left, one door toward the north, and another door toward the south: and the breadth of the place that was left was five cubits round about.* The entrance of the side rooms from the open area were on the north side and on the south side. The open area was five cubits wide all around.
- 12 *Now the building that was before the separate place at the end toward the west was seventy cubits broad; and the wall of the building was five cubits thick round about, and the length thereof ninety cubits.* The building facing the temple courtyard on the west side was seventy cubits wide. The wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, and the building itself was ninety cubits long.

- 13 *So he measured the house, an hundred cubits long; and the separate place, and the building, with the walls thereof, an hundred cubits long;* Then he measured the temple — it was a hundred cubits long. The courtyard at the back of the building, including its walls, was also a hundred cubits long.
- 14 *Also the breadth of the face of the house, and of the separate place toward the east, an hundred cubits.* The width of the front of the temple and the courtyard to the east was also a hundred cubits.
- 15 *And he measured the length of the building over against the separate place which was behind it, and the galleries thereof on the one side and on the other side, an hundred cubits, with the inner temple, and the porches of the court;* He measured the length of the building facing the courtyard at the rear of the temple, with its galleries on each side — one hundred cubits.
- 16 *The door posts, and the narrow windows, and the galleries round about on their three stories, over against the door, cieled with wood round about, and from the ground up to the windows, and the windows were covered;* The inner sanctuary, the outer hall, and the court — as well as the thresholds and the narrow windows and galleries around the three of them — were paneled with wood all around from ground level up to the windows.
- 17 *To that above the door, even unto the inner house, and without, and by all the wall round about within and without, by measure.* The area above the outside of the entrance, and throughout the interior of the inner sanctuary, the outer hall, and all the walls around were decorated all around.
- 18 *And it was made with cherubims and palm trees, so that a palm tree was between a cherub and a cherub; and every cherub had two faces;* The walls were carved with cherubim and palm trees. Between each cherub was a palm tree. Each cherub had two faces.
- 19 *So that the face of a man was toward the palm tree on the one side, and the face of a young lion toward the palm tree on the other side: it was made through all the house round about.* A human face was toward the palm tree on one side, and a lion's face was toward the palm tree on the other. They were carved all around the whole temple.

- 20 *From the ground unto above the door were cherubims and palm trees made, and on the wall of the temple.* From the floor to the area above the entrance, cherubim and palm trees were carved on the wall of the outer sanctuary.
- 21 *The posts of the temple were squared, and the face of the sanctuary; the appearance of the one as the appearance of the other.* The doorposts of the outer sanctuary were square. In front of the Most Holy Place was something that looked like
- 22 *The altar of wood was three cubits high, and the length thereof two cubits; and the corners thereof, and the length thereof, and the walls thereof, were of wood: and he said unto me, This is the table that is before the LORD.* a wooden altar — three cubits high and two cubits square. Its corners, its base, and its sides were of wood. The man said to me, "This is the table that is before the LORD."
- 23 *And the temple and the sanctuary had two doors.* The outer sanctuary and the Most Holy Place each had a double door.
- 24 *And the doors had two leaves apiece, two turning leaves; two leaves for the one door, and two leaves for the other door.* Each door had two panels — two swinging panels for each door.
- 25 *And there were made on them, on the doors of the temple, cherubims and palm trees, like as were made upon the walls; and there were thick planks upon the face of the porch without.* On the doors of the outer sanctuary were carved cherubim and palm trees, like those carved on the walls. A wooden overhang covered the front of the portico.
- 26 *And there were narrow windows and palm trees on the one side and on the other side, on the sides of the porch, and upon the side chambers of the house, and thick planks.* The sidewalls of the portico had narrow windows with palm trees on each side. The side rooms of the temple also had overhangs.

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 Kgs 6:17; 2 Chr 3:3; 1 Kgs 6:2
v4 — 1 Kgs 6:20
v7 — 1 Kgs 6:8
v11 — Ezek 41:9
v15 — Ezek 42:3
v16 — 1 Kgs 6:4
v18 — 1 Kgs 7:36
v22 — Mal 1:7; Mal 1:12; Ezek 44:16; Ezek 23:41
v26 — Ezek 41:16

Chapter 42

The man measures the priestly chambers on the north and south sides of the temple, where the priests will eat the most holy offerings and change their garments. He then measures the outer perimeter of the entire temple complex — five hundred cubits on each side — to separate the holy from the common.

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| <p>1 <i>Then he brought me forth into the utter court, the way toward the north: and he brought me into the chamber that was over against the separate place, and which was before the building toward the north.</i></p> | <p>Then the man led me northward into the outer court and brought me to the rooms opposite the temple courtyard and opposite the outer wall on the north side.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Before the length of an hundred cubits was the north door, and the breadth was fifty cubits.</i></p> | <p>The building whose door faced north was a hundred cubits long and fifty cubits wide.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Over against the twenty cubits which were for the inner court, and over against the pavement which was for the utter court, was gallery against gallery in three stories.</i></p> | <p>Facing the twenty cubits of the inner court and facing the pavement of the outer court, gallery faced gallery in three tiers.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And before the chambers was a walk of ten cubits breadth inward, a way of one cubit; and their doors toward the north.</i></p> | <p>In front of the rooms was an inner passageway ten cubits wide and a hundred cubits long. Their doors were on the north.</p> |

- 5 *Now the upper chambers were shorter: for the galleries were higher than these, than the lower, and than the middlemost of the building.* The upper rooms were narrower because the galleries took more space from them than from the rooms on the lower and middle floors of the building.
- 6 *For they were in three stories, but had not pillars as the pillars of the courts: therefore the building was straitened more than the lowest and the middlemost from the ground.* The rooms on the top floor had no pillars, as the courts had. So they were smaller in floor space than those on the lower and middle floors.
- 7 *And the wall that was without over against the chambers, toward the utter court on the forepart of the chambers, the length thereof was fifty cubits.* There was an outer wall parallel to the rooms and to the outer court — fifty cubits long.
- 8 *For the length of the chambers that were in the utter court was fifty cubits: and, lo, before the temple were an hundred cubits.* The row of rooms on the side next to the outer court was fifty cubits long. In contrast, the row on the side next to the sanctuary was a hundred cubits long.
- 9 *And from under these chambers was the entry on the east side, as one goeth into them from the utter court.* The lower rooms had an entrance on the east side as one enters them from the outer court.
- 10 *The chambers were in the thickness of the wall of the court toward the east, over against the separate place, and over against the building.* On the south side along the length of the wall of the outer court, adjoining the temple courtyard and opposite the outer wall, were rooms
- 11 *And the way before them was like the appearance of the chambers which were toward the north, as long as they, and as broad as they: and all their goings out were both according to their fashions, and according to their doors.* with a passageway in front of them. These were like the rooms on the north. They had the same length and width, with similar exits and dimensions.

- 12 *And according to the doors of the chambers that were toward the south was a door in the head of the way, even the way directly before the wall toward the east, as one entereth into them.*
- Similar to the doorways on the north were the doorways of the rooms on the south. There was a doorway at the beginning of the passageway — the passageway parallel to the corresponding wall extending eastward, by which one enters the rooms.
- 13 *Then said he unto me, The north chambers and the south chambers, which are before the separate place, they be holy chambers, where the priests that approach unto the LORD shall eat the most holy things: there shall they lay the most holy things, and the meat offering, and the sin offering, and the trespass offering; for the place is holy.*
- Then He said to me, "The north and south rooms facing the temple courtyard are the priests' rooms, where the priests who approach the LORD will eat the most holy offerings. There they will put the most holy offerings — the grain offerings, the sin offerings, and the guilt offerings — for the place is holy."
- 14 *When the priests enter therein, then shall they not go out of the holy place into the utter court, but there they shall lay their garments wherein they minister; for they are holy; and shall put on other garments, and shall approach to those things which are for the people.*
- "Once the priests enter the holy precincts, they are not to go into the outer court until they leave behind the garments in which they minister, for these are holy. They are to put on other clothes before they go near the places that are for the people."
- 15 *Now when he had made an end of measuring the inner house, he brought me forth toward the gate whose prospect is toward the east, and measured it round about.*
- When He had finished measuring inside the temple area, He led me out by the east gate and measured the area all around.
- 16 *He measured the east side with the measuring reed, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.*
- He measured the east side with the measuring rod — five hundred cubits by the measuring rod all around.

17	<i>He measured the north side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.</i>	He measured the north side — five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
18	<i>He measured the south side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed.</i>	He measured the south side — five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
19	<i>He turned about to the west side, and measured five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.</i>	He turned to the west side and measured — five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
20	<i>He measured it by the four sides: it had a wall round about, five hundred reeds long, and five hundred broad, to make a separation between the sanctuary and the profane place.</i>	So He measured the area on all four sides. It had a wall all around it, five hundred cubits long and five hundred cubits wide, to separate the holy from the common.

Words in this chapter:

- sin offering** — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.
- trespass offering** — A guilt sacrifice specifically for violations against God or another person — required restitution plus a fifth more.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ezek 40:17; Ezek 40:20
- v3** — Ezek 41:15-16
- v9** — Ezek 46:19
- v10** — Ezek 42:1
- v13** — Lev 7:6; Lev 10:17; Ezek 40:46
- v14** — Ezek 44:19
- v20** — Ezek 45:2; Ezek 40:5; Ezek 22:26

Chapter 43

The glory of the LORD returns to the temple through the east gate — the same glory Ezekiel saw by the river Chebar. The LORD declares this is the place of His throne where He will dwell among the children of Israel forever. The measurements and consecration of the altar are given, along with seven days of purification offerings.

- 1 *Afterward he brought me to the gate, even the gate that looketh toward the east:* Then the man brought me to the gate facing east.
- 2 *And, behold, the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the east: and his voice was like a noise of many waters: and the earth shined with his glory.* The glory of the God of Israel was coming from the east. His voice was like the roar of rushing waters, and the land was radiant with His glory.
- 3 *And it was according to the appearance of the vision which I saw, even according to the vision that I saw when I came to destroy the city: and the visions were like the vision that I saw by the river Chebar; and I fell upon my face.* The vision I saw was like the vision I had seen when He came to destroy the city, and like the visions I had seen by the river Chebar. I fell facedown.
- 4 *And the glory of the LORD came into the house by the way of the gate whose prospect is toward the east.* The glory of the LORD entered the temple through the gate facing east.
- 5 *So the spirit took me up, and brought me into the inner court; and, behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house.* Then the Spirit lifted me up and brought me into the inner court, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple.
- 6 *And I heard him speaking unto me out of the house; and the man stood by me.* While the man was standing beside me, I heard someone speaking to me from inside the temple.
- 7 *And he said unto me, Son of man, the place of my throne, and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel for ever, and my holy name, shall the house of Israel no more defile, neither they, nor their kings, by their whoredom, nor by the carcasses of their kings in their high places.* He said: "Son of man, this is the place of My throne and the place for the soles of My feet. This is where I will live among the Israelites forever. The house of Israel will never again defile My holy name — neither they nor their kings — by their whoredom and the funeral offerings for their kings at their death."

- 8 *In their setting of their threshold by my thresholds, and their post by my posts, and the wall between me and them, they have even defiled my holy name by their abominations that they have committed: wherefore I have consumed them in mine anger.* "When they placed their threshold next to My threshold and their doorposts beside My doorposts, with only a wall between Me and them, they defiled My holy name by their detestable practices. So I destroyed them in My anger."
- 9 *Now let them put away their whoredom, and the carcasses of their kings, far from me, and I will dwell in the midst of them for ever.* "Now let them put away from Me their whoredom and the funeral offerings for their kings, and I will live among them forever."
- 10 *Thou son of man, shew the house to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities: and let them measure the pattern.* "Son of man, describe the temple to the people of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their sins. Let them consider its perfection."
- 11 *And if they be ashamed of all that they have done, shew them the form of the house, and the fashion thereof, and the goings out thereof, and the comings in thereof, and all the forms thereof, and all the ordinances thereof, and all the forms thereof, and all the laws thereof: and write it in their sight, that they may keep the whole form thereof, and all the ordinances thereof, and do them.* "If they are ashamed of all they have done, make known to them the design of the temple — its arrangement, its exits and entrances, its whole design and all its regulations and laws. Write these down before them so that they may be faithful to its design and follow all its regulations."
- 12 *This is the law of the house; Upon the top of the mountain the whole limit thereof round about shall be most holy. Behold, this is the law of the house.* "This is the law of the temple: All the surrounding area on top of the mountain will be most holy. Such is the law of the temple."

- 13 *And these are the measures of the altar after the cubits: The cubit is a cubit and an hand breadth; even the bottom shall be a cubit, and the breadth a cubit, and the border thereof by the edge thereof round about shall be a span: and this shall be the higher base of the altar.* These are the measurements of the altar in long cubits, that cubit being a cubit and a handbreadth: Its gutter is a cubit deep and a cubit wide, with a rim of one span around the edge. And this is the height of the altar:
- 14 *And from the bottom upon the ground even to the lower settle shall be two cubits, and the breadth one cubit; and from the lesser settle even to the greater settle shall be four cubits, and the breadth one cubit.* From the gutter on the ground up to the lower ledge it is two cubits high and one cubit wide, and from the smaller ledge up to the larger ledge it is four cubits high and one cubit wide.
- 15 *So the altar shall be four cubits; and from the altar and upward shall be four horns.* The altar hearth is four cubits high, and four horns project upward from the hearth.
- 16 *And the altar shall be twelve cubits long, twelve broad, square in the four squares thereof.* The altar hearth is twelve cubits long and twelve cubits wide — a square.
- 17 *And the settle shall be fourteen cubits long and fourteen broad in the four squares thereof; and the border about it shall be half a cubit; and the bottom thereof shall be a cubit about; and his stairs shall look toward the east.* The upper ledge is also a square, fourteen cubits long and fourteen cubits wide. All around the altar is a gutter of one cubit with a rim of half a cubit. The steps of the altar face east.
- 18 *And he said unto me, Son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD; These are the ordinances of the altar in the day when they shall make it, to offer burnt offerings thereon, and to sprinkle blood thereon.* Then He said to me, "Son of man, this is what the Lord GOD says: These will be the regulations for sacrificing burnt offerings and sprinkling blood on the altar when it is built."

- 19 *And thou shalt give to the priests the Levites that be of the seed of Zadok, which approach unto me, to minister unto me, saith the Lord GOD, a young bullock for a sin offering.* "You are to give a young bull as a sin offering to the Levitical priests of the family of Zadok, who come near to minister before Me, declares the Lord GOD."
- 20 *And thou shalt take of the blood thereof, and put it on the four horns of it, and on the four corners of the settle, and upon the border round about: thus shalt thou cleanse and purge it.* "You are to take some of its blood and put it on the four horns of the altar and on the four corners of the upper ledge and all around the rim, and so purify the altar and make atonement for it."
- **WORD NOTE** — **Atonement** (uh-TONE-ment) — "the payment for sin that brings God and man back together." In the temple rituals, blood was used to cleanse the altar and make atonement — picturing how Christ's blood would one day make full atonement for human sin.
- 21 *Thou shalt take the bullock also of the sin offering, and he shall burn it in the appointed place of the house, without the sanctuary.* "You are to take the bull for the sin offering and burn it in the designated part of the temple area outside the sanctuary."
- 22 *And on the second day thou shalt offer a kid of the goats without blemish for a sin offering; and they shall cleanse the altar, as they did cleanse it with the bullock.* "On the second day You are to offer a male goat without defect for a sin offering, and the altar is to be purified as it was purified with the bull."
- 23 *When thou hast made an end of cleansing it, thou shalt offer a young bullock without blemish, and a ram out of the flock without blemish.* "When You have finished purifying it, You are to offer a young bull and a ram from the flock, both without defect."
- 24 *And thou shalt offer them before the LORD, and the priests shall cast salt upon them, and they shall offer them up for a burnt offering unto the LORD.* "You are to offer them before the LORD, and the priests are to sprinkle salt on them and sacrifice them as a burnt offering to the LORD."

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| <p>25 <i>Seven days shalt thou prepare every day a goat for a sin offering; they shall also prepare a young bullock, and a ram out of the flock, without blemish.</i></p> <p>26 <i>Seven days shall they purge the altar and purify it; and they shall consecrate themselves.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And when these days are expired, it shall be, that upon the eighth day, and so forward, the priests shall make your burnt offerings upon the altar, and your peace offerings; and I will accept you, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> | <p>"For seven days You are to provide a male goat daily for a sin offering. You are also to provide a young bull and a ram from the flock, both without defect."</p> <p>"For seven days they are to make atonement for the altar and cleanse it, thus dedicating it."</p> <p>"At the end of these days, from the eighth day on, the priests are to present Your burnt offerings and fellowship offerings on the altar. Then I will accept You, declares the Lord GOD."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

peace offering — A shared sacrifice where parts went to God, the priest, and the worshipper — celebrating fellowship and restored relationship with God.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 44:1; Ezek 42:15
- v2 — Rev 18:1; Isa 6:3; Ezek 11:23; Rev 1:15; Rev 14:2
- v5 — 2 Cor 12:2-4
- v7 — Ezek 43:9; Ps 47:8
- v9 — Ezek 43:7
- v10 — Ezek 40:4
- v12 — Ezek 40:2
- v15 — Ex 27:2
- v17 — Ex 20:26
- v19 — Ezek 44:15; Ezek 40:46
- v21 — Ex 29:14
- v24 — Lev 2:13; Mark 9:49-50

Chapter 44

The east gate of the sanctuary is to remain shut because the LORD has entered through it; only the prince may sit in it to eat bread before the LORD. The Levites who went astray will serve in the temple but not approach the altar; only the sons of Zadok, who remained faithful, will minister before the LORD.

- 1 *Then he brought me back the way of the gate of the outward sanctuary which looketh toward the east; and it was shut.* Then the man brought me back to the outer gate of the sanctuary, the one facing east. It was shut.
- 2 *Then said the LORD unto me; This gate shall be shut, it shall not be opened, and no man shall enter in by it; because the LORD, the God of Israel, hath entered in by it, therefore it shall be shut.* The LORD said to me, "This gate is to remain shut. It must not be opened. No one may enter through it. It is to remain shut because the LORD, the God of Israel, has entered through it."
- 3 *It is for the prince; the prince, he shall sit in it to eat bread before the LORD; he shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate, and shall go out by the way of the same.* "The prince himself is the only one who may sit inside the gateway to eat in the presence of the LORD. He is to enter by way of the portico of the gateway and go out the same way."
- 4 *Then brought he me the way of the north gate before the house: and I looked, and, behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house of the LORD: and I fell upon my face.* Then the man brought me by way of the north gate to the front of the temple. I looked and saw the glory of the LORD filling the temple of the LORD, and I fell facedown.
- 5 *And the LORD said unto me, Son of man, mark well, and behold with thine eyes, and hear with thine ears all that I say unto thee concerning all the ordinances of the house of the LORD, and all the laws thereof; and mark well the entering in of the house, with every going forth of the sanctuary.* The LORD said to me, "Son of man, look carefully. Listen carefully. Pay attention to everything I tell You concerning all the regulations and instructions about the temple of the LORD. Note carefully the entrance to the temple and all the exits of the sanctuary."
- 6 *And thou shalt say to the rebellious, even to the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; O ye house of Israel, let it suffice you of all your abominations,* "Say to the rebellious house of Israel: This is what the Lord GOD says: Enough of Your detestable practices, house of Israel!"

- 7 *In that ye have brought into my sanctuary strangers, uncircumcised in heart, and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in my sanctuary, to pollute it, even my house, when ye offer my bread, the fat and the blood, and they have broken my covenant because of all your abominations.* "In addition to all Your other detestable practices, You brought foreigners uncircumcised in heart and flesh into My sanctuary, desecrating My temple while You offered Me food, fat, and blood. You broke My covenant by doing all these detestable things."
- 8 *And ye have not kept the charge of mine holy things: but ye have set keepers of my charge in my sanctuary for yourselves.* "Instead of carrying out Your duty in regard to My holy things, You put others in charge of My sanctuary."
- 9 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; No stranger, uncircumcised in heart, nor uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter into my sanctuary, of any stranger that is among the children of Israel.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: No foreigner uncircumcised in heart and flesh is to enter My sanctuary — not even the foreigners who live among the Israelites."
- 10 *And the Levites that are gone away far from me, when Israel went astray, which went astray away from me after their idols; they shall even bear their iniquity.* "The Levites who went far from Me when Israel went astray and who wandered from Me after their idols must bear the consequences of their sin."
- 11 *Yet they shall be ministers in my sanctuary, having charge at the gates of the house, and ministering to the house: they shall slay the burnt offering and the sacrifice for the people, and they shall stand before them to minister unto them.* "They may serve in My sanctuary, having supervisory duties at the gates of the temple and serving in it. They may slaughter the burnt offerings and sacrifices for the people and stand before the people and serve them."

- 12 *Because they ministered unto them before their idols, and caused the house of Israel to fall into iniquity; therefore have I lifted up mine hand against them, saith the Lord GOD, and they shall bear their iniquity.* "But because they served the people in the presence of their idols and made the house of Israel fall into sin, therefore I have sworn with uplifted hand that they must bear the consequences of their sin, declares the Lord GOD."
- 13 *And they shall not come near unto me, to do the office of a priest unto me, nor to come near to any of my holy things, in the most holy place: but they shall bear their shame, and their abominations which they have committed.* "They are not to come near to serve Me as priests or come near any of My holy things or My most holy offerings. They must bear the shame of the detestable things they have done."
- 14 *But I will make them keepers of the charge of the house, for all the service thereof, and for all that shall be done therein.* "Yet I will put them in charge of the duties of the temple and all the work that is to be done in it."
- 15 *But the priests the Levites, the sons of Zadok, that kept the charge of my sanctuary when the children of Israel went astray from me, they shall come near to me to minister unto me, and they shall stand before me to offer unto me the fat and the blood, saith the Lord GOD:* "But the Levitical priests, who are descendants of Zadok and who guarded My sanctuary when the Israelites went astray from Me, are to come near to minister before Me. They are to stand before Me to offer sacrifices of fat and blood, declares the Lord GOD."
- 16 *They shall enter into my sanctuary, and they shall come near to my table, to minister unto me, and they shall keep my charge.* "They alone are to enter My sanctuary. They alone are to come near My table to minister before Me and perform My service."

- 17 *And it shall come to pass, that when they enter in at the gates of the inner court, they shall be clothed with linen garments; and no wool shall come upon them, whiles they minister in the gates of the inner court, and within.* "When they enter the gates of the inner court, they are to wear linen clothes. They must not wear any woolen garment while ministering at the gates of the inner court or inside the temple."
- 18 *They shall have linen bonnets upon their heads, and shall have linen breeches upon their loins; they shall not gird themselves with any thing that causeth sweat.* "They are to wear linen turbans on their heads and linen undergarments around their waists. They must not wear anything that makes them perspire."
- 19 *And when they go forth into the utter court, even into the utter court to the people, they shall put off their garments wherein they ministered, and lay them in the holy chambers, and they shall put on other garments; and they shall not sanctify the people with their garments.* "When they go out into the outer court where the people are, they are to take off the clothes they have been ministering in and are to leave them in the sacred rooms, and put on other clothes, so that the people are not consecrated through contact with their garments."
- 20 *Neither shall they shave their heads, nor suffer their locks to grow long; they shall only poll their heads.* "They must not shave their heads or let their hair grow long, but they are to keep their hair trimmed."
- 21 *Neither shall any priest drink wine, when they enter into the inner court.* "No priest is to drink wine when He enters the inner court."
- 22 *Neither shall they take for their wives a widow, nor her that is put away: but they shall take maidens of the seed of the house of Israel, or a widow that had a priest before.* "They must not marry widows or divorced women. They may marry only virgins of Israelite descent or widows of priests."
- 23 *And they shall teach my people the difference between the holy and profane, and cause them to discern between the unclean and the clean.* "They are to teach My people the difference between the holy and the common and show them how to distinguish between the unclean and the clean."

- 24 *And in controversy they shall stand in judgment; and they shall judge it according to my judgments: and they shall keep my laws and my statutes in all mine assemblies; and they shall hallow my sabbaths.* "In any dispute, the priests are to serve as judges and decide it according to My ordinances. They are to keep My laws and My decrees for all My appointed festivals, and they are to keep My Sabbaths holy."
- 25 *And they shall come at no dead person to defile themselves: but for father, or for mother, or for son, or for daughter, for brother, or for sister that hath had no husband, they may defile themselves.* "A priest must not defile Himself by going near a dead person. However, for a father or mother, son or daughter, brother or unmarried sister He may make Himself unclean."
- 26 *And after he is cleansed, they shall reckon unto him seven days.* "After a priest is cleansed, He must wait seven days."
- 27 *And in the day that he goeth into the sanctuary, unto the inner court, to minister in the sanctuary, he shall offer his sin offering, saith the Lord GOD.* "On the day He goes into the inner court of the sanctuary to minister in the sanctuary, He is to offer a sin offering for Himself, declares the Lord GOD."
- 28 *And it shall be unto them for an inheritance: I am their inheritance: and ye shall give them no possession in Israel: I am their possession.* "I am to be the only inheritance the priests have. You are to give them no possession in Israel. I will be their possession."
- 29 *They shall eat the meat offering, and the sin offering, and the trespass offering; and every dedicated thing in Israel shall be theirs.* "They will eat the grain offerings, the sin offerings, and the guilt offerings. Every devoted thing in Israel will belong to them."
- 30 *And the first of all the firstfruits of all things, and every oblation of all, of every sort of your oblations, shall be for the priests: ye shall also give unto the priest the first of your dough, that he may cause the blessing to rest in thine house.* "The best of all the firstfruits and all Your special gifts will belong to the priests. You are to give them the first portion of Your ground meal so that a blessing may rest on Your household."

- 31 *The priests shall not eat of any thing that is dead of itself, or torn, whether it be fowl or beast.* "The priests must not eat anything, bird or animal, found dead or torn by wild animals."

Words in this chapter:

poll — A single head — used in census contexts meaning 'per person'; 'every male by their polls' means 'each male individually.'

Cross-References:

- v3** — Ezek 46:2; Ezek 37:25; Ezek 34:24; 1 Cor 10:18-33; Gen 31:54
v4 — Ezek 1:28; Rev 1:17; Ezek 3:23
v7 — Lev 22:25; Jer 9:26; Jer 4:4
v9 — Joel 3:17; Zech 14:21
v15 — Ezek 48:11; Deut 10:8
v16 — Ezek 41:22
v19 — Ezek 46:20; Lev 6:27
v22 — Lev 21:7; Lev 21:13-14
v23 — Ezek 22:26; Lev 10:10-11; 2 Tim 2:24-25; Hos 4:6
v28 — Josh 13:33; Num 18:20; Deut 18:1-2
v29 — Num 18:14; Lev 27:21
v30 — Neh 10:35-37; 2 Chr 31:10; Deut 18:4; Num 15:19-21; Num 18:12-18

Chapter 45

The LORD designates a holy portion of the land for the sanctuary, the priests, the Levites, and the city. The prince is given his own land on either side and is charged to use just balances, weights, and measures. Regulations for the prince's offerings at Passover and the feast of tabernacles are established.

- 1 *Moreover, when ye shall divide by lot the land for inheritance, ye shall offer an oblation unto the LORD, an holy portion of the land: the length shall be the length of five and twenty thousand reeds, and the breadth shall be ten thousand. This shall be holy in all the borders thereof round about.* "When You divide the land by lot for an inheritance, you are to present to the LORD a portion of the land as a sacred district — twenty-five thousand cubits long and twenty thousand cubits wide. The entire area will be holy."

- 2 *Of this there shall be for the sanctuary five hundred in length, with five hundred in breadth, square round about; and fifty cubits round about for the suburbs thereof.* "Of this, a section five hundred cubits square is to be for the sanctuary, with fifty cubits of open land around it."
- 3 *And of this measure shalt thou measure the length of five and twenty thousand, and the breadth of ten thousand: and in it shall be the sanctuary and the most holy place.* "In the sacred district, measure off a section twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand cubits wide. In it will be the sanctuary — the Most Holy Place."
- 4 *The holy portion of the land shall be for the priests the ministers of the sanctuary, which shall come near to minister unto the LORD: and it shall be a place for their houses, and an holy place for the sanctuary.* "It will be the sacred portion of the land for the priests, who minister in the sanctuary and who draw near to minister before the LORD. It will be a place for their houses as well as a holy place for the sanctuary."
- 5 *And the five and twenty thousand of length, and the ten thousand of breadth shall also the Levites, the ministers of the house, have for themselves, for a possession for twenty chambers.* "An area twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand cubits wide will belong to the Levites, who serve in the temple, as their possession for towns to live in."
- 6 *And ye shall appoint the possession of the city five thousand broad, and five and twenty thousand long, over against the oblation of the holy portion: it shall be for the whole house of Israel.* "You are to give the city as its property an area five thousand cubits wide and twenty-five thousand cubits long, adjoining the sacred portion. It will belong to all the house of Israel."

- 7 *And a portion shall be for the prince on the one side and on the other side of the oblation of the holy portion, and of the possession of the city, before the oblation of the holy portion, and before the possession of the city, from the west side westward, and from the east side eastward: and the length shall be over against one of the portions, from the west border unto the east border.* "The prince will have the land bordering each side of the area formed by the sacred district and the city property. It will extend westward from the west side and eastward from the east side, running lengthwise from the western to the eastern border."
- 8 *In the land shall be his possession in Israel: and my princes shall no more oppress my people; and the rest of the land shall they give to the house of Israel according to their tribes.* "This land will be his possession in Israel. And My princes will no longer oppress My people but will allow the house of Israel to possess the land according to their tribes."
- 9 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; Let it suffice you, O princes of Israel: remove violence and spoil, and execute judgment and justice, take away your exactions from my people, saith the Lord GOD.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: You have gone far enough, princes of Israel! Give up Your violence and oppression and do what is just and right. Stop dispossessing My people, declares the Lord GOD."
- 10 *Ye shall have just balances, and a just ephah, and a just bath.* "You are to use accurate scales, an accurate ephah, and an accurate bath."
- 11 *The ephah and the bath shall be of one measure, that the bath may contain the tenth part of an homer, and the ephah the tenth part of an homer: the measure thereof shall be after the homer.* "The ephah and the bath are to be the same size, the bath containing a tenth of a homer and the ephah a tenth of a homer. The homer is to be the standard measure for both."
- 12 *And the shekel shall be twenty gerahs: twenty shekels, five and twenty shekels, fifteen shekels, shall be your maneh.* "The shekel is to consist of twenty gerahs. Twenty shekels plus twenty-five shekels plus fifteen shekels equal one mina."

- 13 *This is the oblation that ye shall offer; the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of wheat, and ye shall give the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of barley:* "This is the special gift You are to offer: a sixth of an ephah from each homer of wheat and a sixth of an ephah from each homer of barley."
- 14 *Concerning the ordinance of oil, the bath of oil, ye shall offer the tenth part of a bath out of the cor, which is an homer of ten baths; for ten baths are an homer:* "The prescribed portion of olive oil, measured by the bath, is a tenth of a bath from each cor, which consists of ten baths or one homer — for ten baths are equivalent to a homer."
- 15 *And one lamb out of the flock, out of two hundred, out of the fat pastures of Israel; for a meat offering, and for a burnt offering, and for peace offerings, to make reconciliation for them, saith the Lord GOD.* "Also one sheep is to be taken from every flock of two hundred from the well-watered pastures of Israel. These will be used for the grain offerings, burnt offerings, and fellowship offerings to make atonement for the people, declares the Lord GOD."
- 16 *All the people of the land shall give this oblation for the prince in Israel.* "All the people of the land will be required to give this special gift to the prince in Israel."
- 17 *And it shall be the prince's part to give burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and drink offerings, in the feasts, and in the new moons, and in the sabbaths, in all solemnities of the house of Israel: he shall prepare the sin offering, and the meat offering, and the burnt offering, and the peace offerings, to make reconciliation for the house of Israel.* "It will be the duty of the prince to provide the burnt offerings, grain offerings, and drink offerings at the festivals, the New Moons, and the Sabbaths — at all the appointed festivals of the house of Israel. He will provide the sin offerings, grain offerings, burnt offerings, and fellowship offerings to make atonement for the house of Israel."
- 18 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the first month, in the first day of the month, thou shalt take a young bullock without blemish, and cleanse the sanctuary:* "This is what the Lord GOD says: In the first month on the first day You are to take a young bull without defect and purify the sanctuary."

- 19 *And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering, and put it upon the posts of the house, and upon the four corners of the settle of the altar, and upon the posts of the gate of the inner court.* "The priest is to take some of the blood of the sin offering and put it on the doorposts of the temple, on the four corners of the upper ledge of the altar, and on the gateposts of the inner court."
- 20 *And so thou shalt do the seventh day of the month for every one that erreth, and for him that is simple: so shall ye reconcile the house.* "You are to do the same on the seventh day of the month for anyone who sins unintentionally or through ignorance. So you are to make atonement for the temple."
- 21 *In the first month, in the fourteenth day of the month, ye shall have the passover, a feast of seven days; unleavened bread shall be eaten.* "In the first month on the fourteenth day you are to observe the Passover. For seven days the bread eaten is to be without yeast."
- 22 *And upon that day shall the prince prepare for himself and for all the people of the land a bullock for a sin offering.* "On that day the prince is to provide a bull as a sin offering for himself and for all the people of the land."
- 23 *And seven days of the feast he shall prepare a burnt offering to the LORD, seven bullocks and seven rams without blemish daily the seven days; and a kid of the goats daily for a sin offering.* "Every day during the seven days of the festival He is to provide seven bulls and seven rams without defect as a burnt offering to the LORD, and a male goat as a sin offering each day."
- 24 *And he shall prepare a meat offering of an ephah for a bullock, and an ephah for a ram, and an hin of oil for an ephah.* "He is to provide as a grain offering an ephah for each bull and an ephah for each ram, along with a hin of oil for each ephah."

- 25 *In the seventh month, in the fifteenth day of the month, shall he do the like in the feast of the seven days, according to the sin offering, according to the burnt offering, and according to the meat offering, and according to the oil.*
- "During the seven days of the festival, which begins in the seventh month on the fifteenth day, He is to make the same provision for sin offerings, burnt offerings, grain offerings, and oil."

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 48:29
- v5 — Ezek 48:13
- v7 — Ezek 48:21
- v8 — Isa 11:3-5; Ezek 46:18
- v9 — Zech 8:16; Isa 1:17; Ezek 44:6; Jer 22:3
- v11 — Isa 5:10
- v12 — Ex 30:13; Lev 27:25; Num 3:47
- v15 — Lev 1:4
- v18 — Lev 16:16
- v19 — Ezek 43:20
- v25 — Lev 23:33-43

Chapter 46

Regulations are given for the prince's worship at the east gate on the Sabbath and New Moon, and for the people's movement through the gates during the appointed feasts. The prince may give portions of his inheritance to his sons permanently but only lend to his servants. Ezekiel is shown the kitchens where the priests and ministers will boil the offerings.

- 1 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; The gate of the inner court that looketh toward the east shall be shut the six working days; but on the sabbath it shall be opened, and in the day of the new moon it shall be opened.*
- "This is what the Lord GOD says: The gate of the inner court facing east is to be shut on the six working days, but on the Sabbath day and on the day of the New Moon it is to be opened."

- 2 *And the prince shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate without, and shall stand by the post of the gate, and the priests shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, and he shall worship at the threshold of the gate: then he shall go out; but the gate shall not be shut until the evening.* "The prince is to enter from the outside through the portico of the gateway and stand by the gatepost. The priests are to sacrifice his burnt offering and his fellowship offerings. He is to worship at the threshold of the gateway and then go out, but the gate will not be shut until evening."
- 3 *Likewise the people of the land shall worship at the door of this gate before the LORD in the sabbaths and in the new moons.* "On the Sabbaths and New Moons the people of the land are to worship in the presence of the LORD at the entrance of that gateway."
- 4 *And the burnt offering that the prince shall offer unto the LORD in the sabbath day shall be six lambs without blemish, and a ram without blemish.* "The burnt offering the prince brings to the LORD on the Sabbath day is to be six male lambs and a ram, all without defect."
- 5 *And the meat offering shall be an ephah for a ram, and the meat offering for the lambs as he shall be able to give, and an hin of oil to an ephah.* "The grain offering given with the ram is to be an ephah, and the grain offering with the lambs is to be as much as He wants to give, along with a hin of oil for each ephah."
- 6 *And in the day of the new moon it shall be a young bullock without blemish, and six lambs, and a ram: they shall be without blemish.* "On the day of the New Moon He is to offer a young bull, six lambs, and a ram, all without defect."
- 7 *And he shall prepare a meat offering, an ephah for a bullock, and an ephah for a ram, and for the lambs according as his hand shall attain unto, and an hin of oil to an ephah.* "He is to provide as a grain offering one ephah with the bull, one ephah with the ram, and with the lambs as much as He wants to give, along with a hin of oil for each ephah."

- 8 *And when the prince shall enter, he shall go in by the way of the porch of that gate, and he shall go forth by the way thereof.* "When the prince enters, he is to go in through the portico of the gateway, and he is to go out the same way."
- 9 *But when the people of the land shall come before the LORD in the solemn feasts, he that entereth in by the way of the north gate to worship shall go out by the way of the south gate; and he that entereth by the way of the south gate shall go forth by the way of the north gate: he shall not return by the way of the gate whereby he came in, but shall go forth over against it.* "When the people of the land come before the LORD at the appointed festivals, whoever enters by the north gate to worship is to go out by the south gate, and whoever enters by the south gate is to go out by the north gate. No one is to return through the gate by which he entered, but each is to go out through the opposite gate."
- 10 *And the prince in the midst of them, when they go in, shall go in; and when they go forth, shall go forth.* "The prince is to be among them, going in when they go in and going out when they go out."
- 11 *And in the feasts and in the solemnities the meat offering shall be an ephah to a bullock, and an ephah to a ram, and to the lambs as he is able to give, and an hin of oil to an ephah.* "At the festivals and the appointed feasts, the grain offering is to be an ephah with a bull, an ephah with a ram, and with the lambs as much as he wants to give, along with a hin of oil for each ephah."
- 12 *Now when the prince shall prepare a voluntary burnt offering or peace offerings voluntarily unto the LORD, one shall then open him the gate that looketh toward the east, and he shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, as he did on the sabbath day: then he shall go out; and after his going out, one shall shut the gate.* "When the prince provides a freewill offering — whether a burnt offering or fellowship offerings — as a freewill offering to the LORD, the east gate is to be opened for Him. He is to offer His burnt offering or His fellowship offerings as He does on the Sabbath day. Then He shall go out, and after He has gone out, the gate will be shut."

- 13 *Thou shalt daily prepare a burnt offering unto the LORD of a lamb of the first year without blemish: thou shalt prepare it every morning.* "Every day You are to provide a year-old lamb without defect for a burnt offering to the LORD. You are to do this every morning."
- 14 *And thou shalt prepare a meat offering for it every morning, the sixth part of an ephah, and the third part of an hin of oil, to temper with the fine flour; a meat offering continually by a perpetual ordinance unto the LORD.* "You are also to provide a grain offering with it every morning — a sixth of an ephah with a third of a hin of oil to moisten the flour. The grain offering to the LORD is a lasting ordinance."
- 15 *Thus shall they prepare the lamb, and the meat offering, and the oil, every morning for a continual burnt offering.* "So the lamb, the grain offering, and the oil shall be provided every morning as a regular burnt offering."
- 16 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; If the prince give a gift unto any of his sons, the inheritance thereof shall be his sons'; it shall be their possession by inheritance.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: If the prince makes a gift from his inheritance to one of His sons, it will also belong to His descendants. It is to be their property by inheritance."
- 17 *But if he give a gift of his inheritance to one of his servants, then it shall be his to the year of liberty; after it shall return to the prince: but his inheritance shall be his sons' for them.* "If, however, he makes a gift from his inheritance to one of his servants, the servant may keep it until the year of freedom. At that time it will revert to the prince. His inheritance belongs to his sons only; it shall be theirs."
- 18 *Moreover the prince shall not take of the people's inheritance by oppression, to thrust them out of their possession; but he shall give his sons inheritance out of his own possession: that my people be not scattered every man from his possession.* "The prince must not take any of the inheritance of the people, driving them off their property. He is to give his sons their inheritance out of his own property, so that none of My people will be separated from his property."

- 19 *After he brought me through the entry, which was at the side of the gate, into the holy chambers of the priests, which looked toward the north: and, behold, there was a place on the two sides westward.* Then the man brought me through the entrance at the side of the gate to the sacred rooms facing north, which belonged to the priests. And I saw a place at the far end on the west side.
- 20 *Then said he unto me, This is the place where the priests shall boil the trespass offering and the sin offering, where they shall bake the meat offering; that they bear them not out into the utter court, to sanctify the people.* He said to me, "This is the place where the priests will cook the guilt offering and the sin offering and bake the grain offering, to avoid bringing them into the outer court and consecrating the people there."
- 21 *Then he brought me forth into the utter court, and caused me to pass by the four corners of the court; and, behold, in every corner of the court there was a court.* He then brought me out into the outer court and led me around to its four corners. In each corner of the outer court was another court —
- 22 *In the four corners of the court there were courts joined of forty cubits long and thirty broad: these four corners were of one measure.* enclosed courts forty cubits long and thirty cubits wide — all four of them were the same size.
- 23 *And there was a row of building round about in them, round about them four, and it was made with boiling places under the rows round about.* Around the inside of each of the four courts was a ledge of stonework, with cooking places built below the ledge all around the inside.
- 24 *Then said he unto me, These are the places of them that boil, where the ministers of the house shall boil the sacrifice of the people.* He said to me, "These are the kitchens where those who minister at the temple are to cook the sacrifices of the people."

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (SAB-ath) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 66:23
- v2 — Ezek 44:3
- v5 — Ezek 45:24
- v8 — Ezek 46:2
- v9 — Deut 16:16
- v10 — Ps 42:4
- v11 — Ezek 46:5
- v17 — Lev 25:10
- v18 — Ezek 45:8

Chapter 47

Ezekiel sees water flowing from under the threshold of the temple toward the east, growing from ankle-deep to knee-deep to a river that cannot be crossed. Wherever the river flows, everything will live — even the Dead Sea will be healed and filled with fish. The boundaries of the restored land are set for the twelve tribes, and strangers who dwell among them will receive an inheritance.

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| 1 <i>Afterward he brought me again unto the door of the house; and, behold, waters issued out from under the threshold of the house eastward: for the forefront of the house stood toward the east, and the waters came down from under from the right side of the house, at the south side of the altar.</i> | The man brought me back to the entrance of the temple, and I saw water flowing from under the threshold of the temple toward the east, for the temple faced east. The water was coming down from under the south side of the temple, south of the altar. |
| 2 <i>Then brought he me out of the way of the gate northward, and led me about the way without unto the utter gate by the way that looketh eastward; and, behold, there ran out waters on the right side.</i> | Then he brought me out through the north gate and led me around the outside to the outer gate facing east, and the water was trickling from the south side. |
| 3 <i>And when the man that had the line in his hand went forth eastward, he measured a thousand cubits, and he brought me through the waters; the waters were to the ankles.</i> | As the man went eastward with a measuring line in his hand, he measured off a thousand cubits and then led me through water that was ankle-deep. |

- 4 *Again he measured a thousand, and brought me through the waters; the waters were to the knees. Again he measured a thousand, and brought me through; the waters were to the loins.* He measured off another thousand cubits and led me through water that was knee-deep. He measured off another thousand and led me through water that was up to the waist.
- 5 *Afterward he measured a thousand; and it was a river that I could not pass over: for the waters were risen, waters to swim in, a river that could not be passed over.* He measured off another thousand, but now it was a river that I could not cross, because the water had risen and was deep enough to swim in — a river that no one could cross.
- 6 *And he said unto me, Son of man, hast thou seen this? Then he brought me, and caused me to return to the brink of the river.* He asked me, "Son of man, do you see this?" Then he led me back to the bank of the river.
- 7 *Now when I had returned, behold, at the bank of the river were very many trees on the one side and on the other.* When I arrived back at the bank, I saw a great number of trees on each side of the river.
- 8 *Then said he unto me, These waters issue out toward the east country, and go down into the desert, and go into the sea: which being brought forth into the sea, the waters shall be healed.* He said to me, "This water flows toward the eastern region and goes down into the Arabah, where it enters the Dead Sea. When it empties into the sea, the salty water there becomes fresh."
- 9 *And it shall come to pass, that every thing that liveth, which moveth, whithersoever the rivers shall come, shall live: and there shall be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters shall come thither: for they shall be healed; and every thing shall live whither the river cometh.* "Everything that lives and moves, wherever the rivers come, will live. There will be a very great number of fish, because these waters flow there and the waters will be healed. Everything will live wherever the river comes."

- 10 *And it shall come to pass, that the fishers shall stand upon it from Engedi even unto Eneglaim; they shall be a place to spread forth nets; their fish shall be according to their kinds, as the fish of the great sea, exceeding many.* "Fishermen will stand along the shore. From En Gedi to En Eglaim there will be places for spreading nets. The fish will be of many kinds — like the fish of the Mediterranean Sea."
- 11 *But the miry places thereof and the marishes thereof shall not be healed; they shall be given to salt.* "But the swamps and marshes will not become fresh. They will be left for salt."
- 12 *And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.* "Fruit trees of all kinds will grow on both banks of the river. Their leaves will not wither, nor will their fruit fail. Every month they will bear fruit, because the water from the sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will serve for food and their leaves for healing."
- 13 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; This shall be the border, whereby ye shall inherit the land according to the twelve tribes of Israel: Joseph shall have two portions.* "This is what the Lord GOD says: These are the boundaries by which You are to divide the land for an inheritance among the twelve tribes of Israel, with two portions for Joseph."
- 14 *And ye shall inherit it, one as well as another: concerning the which I lifted up mine hand to give it unto your fathers: and this land shall fall unto you for inheritance.* "You are to divide it equally among them. Because I swore with uplifted hand to give it to Your ancestors, this land will become Your inheritance."
- 15 *And this shall be the border of the land toward the north side, from the great sea, the way of Hethlon, as men go to Zedad;* "This is to be the boundary of the land: On the north side it will run from the Mediterranean Sea by the Hethlon road past Lebo Hamath to Zedad —"

- 16 *Hamath, Berothah, Sibraim, which is between the border of Damascus and the border of Hamath; Hazarhatticon, which is by the coast of Hauran.* "Berothah and Sibraim, which lie on the border between Damascus and Hamath, to Hazer Hatticon, which is on the border of Hauran."
- 17 *And the border from the sea shall be Hazarenan, the border of Damascus, and the north northward, and the border of Hamath. And this is the north side.* "The boundary will extend from the sea to Hazar Enan, along the northern border of Damascus, with the border of Hamath to the north. This will be the northern boundary."
- 18 *And the east side ye shall measure from Hauran, and from Damascus, and from Gilead, and from the land of Israel by Jordan, from the border unto the east sea. And this is the east side.* "On the east side the boundary will run between Hauran and Damascus, along the Jordan between Gilead and the land of Israel, to the eastern sea and as far as Tamar. This will be the eastern boundary."
- 19 *And the south side southward, from Tamar even to the waters of strife in Kadesh, the river to the great sea. And this is the south side southward.* "On the south side it will run from Tamar to the waters of Meribah Kadesh, then along the Wadi of Egypt to the Mediterranean Sea. This will be the southern boundary."
- 20 *The west side also shall be the great sea from the border, till a man come over against Hamath. This is the west side.* "On the west side, the Mediterranean Sea will be the boundary to a point opposite Lebo Hamath. This will be the western boundary."
- 21 *So shall ye divide this land unto you according to the tribes of Israel.* "You are to distribute this land among yourselves according to the tribes of Israel."

- 22 *And it shall come to pass, that ye shall divide it by lot for an inheritance unto you, and to the strangers that sojourn among you, which shall beget children among you: and they shall be unto you as born in the country among the children of Israel; they shall have inheritance with you among the tribes of Israel.* "You are to allot it as an inheritance for yourselves and for the foreigners residing among You and who have children. You are to consider them as native-born Israelites. Along with You they are to be allotted an inheritance among the tribes of Israel."
- 23 *And it shall come to pass, that in what tribe the stranger sojourneth, there shall ye give him his inheritance, saith the Lord GOD.* "In whatever tribe a foreigner resides, there You are to give them their inheritance, declares the Lord GOD."

Words in this chapter:

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 22:1; Zech 14:8; Joel 3:18; Isa 55:1; Ezek 47:12
- v3 — Ezek 40:3
- v5 — Isa 11:9; Hab 2:14
- v7 — Ezek 47:12
- v8 — Josh 3:16; Deut 3:17; Deut 4:49; Isa 44:3-5; 2 Kgs 2:19-22
- v9 — John 7:37-38; John 6:63; Isa 55:1; John 4:14
- v10 — Matt 4:19
- v11 — Deut 29:23
- v12 — Rev 22:2; Ps 1:3; Jer 17:8; Ezek 47:7; Gen 2:9
- v15 — Num 34:8
- v22 — Col 3:11; Eph 3:6; Acts 11:18; Rom 10:12; Isa 56:6-7

Chapter 48

The land is divided among the twelve tribes from north to south, with the holy portion in the center containing the sanctuary, the priestly and Levitical territories, and the city. The city has twelve gates named after the twelve tribes of Israel. The name of the city from that day forward shall be "The LORD is there."

- 1 *Now these are the names of the tribes. From the north end to the coast of the way of Hethlon, as one goeth to Hamath, Hazarenan, the border of Damascus northward, to the coast of Hamath; for these are his sides east and west; a portion for Dan.*

These are the tribes, listed by name: At the northern end, Dan will have one portion. It will follow the Hethlon road to Lebo Hamath — Hazar Enan and the northern border of Damascus next to Hamath, extending from east to west.
- 2 *And by the border of Dan, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Asher.*

Adjoining the territory of Dan from east to west will be a portion for Asher.
- 3 *And by the border of Asher, from the east side even unto the west side, a portion for Naphtali.*

Adjoining the territory of Asher from east to west will be a portion for Naphtali.
- 4 *And by the border of Naphtali, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Manasseh.*

Adjoining the territory of Naphtali from east to west will be a portion for Manasseh.
- 5 *And by the border of Manasseh, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Ephraim.*

Adjoining the territory of Manasseh from east to west will be a portion for Ephraim.
- 6 *And by the border of Ephraim, from the east side even unto the west side, a portion for Reuben.*

Adjoining the territory of Ephraim from east to west will be a portion for Reuben.
- 7 *And by the border of Reuben, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Judah.*

Adjoining the territory of Reuben from east to west will be a portion for Judah.
- 8 *And by the border of Judah, from the east side unto the west side, shall be the offering which ye shall offer of five and twenty thousand reeds in breadth, and in length as one of the other parts, from the east side unto the west side: and the sanctuary shall be in the midst of it.*

"Adjoining the territory of Judah from east to west will be the special gift you are to present — twenty-five thousand cubits wide and as long as any of the tribal portions from east to west — with the sanctuary in the center."

- 9 *The oblation that ye shall offer unto the LORD shall be of five and twenty thousand in length, and of ten thousand in breadth.* "The special portion You offer to the LORD will be twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand cubits wide."
- 10 *And for them, even for the priests, shall be this holy oblation; toward the north five and twenty thousand in length, and toward the west ten thousand in breadth, and toward the east ten thousand in breadth, and toward the south five and twenty thousand in length: and the sanctuary of the LORD shall be in the midst thereof.* "This will be the sacred portion for the priests. It will be twenty-five thousand cubits on the north side, ten thousand cubits wide on the west side, ten thousand cubits wide on the east side, and twenty-five thousand cubits on the south side. The LORD's sanctuary will be in the center."
- 11 *It shall be for the priests that are sanctified of the sons of Zadok; which have kept my charge, which went not astray when the children of Israel went astray, as the Levites went astray.* "This will be for the consecrated priests — the sons of Zadok — who kept My charge and did not go astray when the Israelites went astray, as the Levites did."
- 12 *And this oblation of the land that is offered shall be unto them a thing most holy by the border of the Levites.* "It will be a special gift to them from the sacred portion of the land, a most holy portion, bordering the territory of the Levites."
- 13 *And over against the border of the priests the Levites shall have five and twenty thousand in length, and ten thousand in breadth: all the length shall be five and twenty thousand, and the breadth ten thousand.* "Alongside the territory of the priests, the Levites will have an allotment twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand cubits wide. Its total length will be twenty-five thousand cubits and its width ten thousand cubits."
- 14 *And they shall not sell of it, neither exchange, nor alienate the firstfruits of the land: for it is holy unto the LORD.* "They must not sell or exchange any of it. This is the best of the land and must not pass into other hands, because it is holy to the LORD."

- 15 *And the five thousand, that are left in the breadth over against the five and twenty thousand, shall be a profane place for the city, for dwelling, and for suburbs: and the city shall be in the midst thereof.* "The remaining area — five thousand cubits wide and twenty-five thousand cubits long — will be for the common use of the city, for houses and for open land. The city will be in the center."
- 16 *And these shall be the measures thereof; the north side four thousand and five hundred, and the south side four thousand and five hundred, and on the east side four thousand and five hundred, and the west side four thousand and five hundred.* "These will be its measurements: the north side 4,500 cubits, the south side 4,500, the east side 4,500, and the west side 4,500."
- 17 *And the suburbs of the city shall be toward the north two hundred and fifty, and toward the south two hundred and fifty, and toward the east two hundred and fifty, and toward the west two hundred and fifty.* "The open land surrounding the city will be 250 cubits on the north, 250 on the south, 250 on the east, and 250 on the west."
- 18 *And the residue in length over against the oblation of the holy portion shall be ten thousand eastward, and ten thousand westward: and it shall be over against the oblation of the holy portion; and the produce thereof shall be for food unto them that serve the city.* "What remains of the special portion will be ten thousand cubits to the east and ten thousand to the west, adjoining the sacred portion. Its produce will supply food for the workers of the city."
- 19 *And they that serve the city shall serve it out of all the tribes of Israel.* "The workers from the city who farm it will come from all the tribes of Israel."
- 20 *All the oblation shall be five and twenty thousand by five and twenty thousand: ye shall offer the holy oblation foursquare, with the possession of the city.* "The entire special portion will be a square, twenty-five thousand cubits on each side. Set it apart as the sacred portion, along with the property of the city."

- 21 *And the residue shall be for the prince, on the one side and on the other of the holy oblation, and of the possession of the city, over against the five and twenty thousand of the oblation toward the east border, and westward over against the five and twenty thousand toward the west border, over against the portions for the prince: and it shall be the holy oblation; and the sanctuary of the house shall be in the midst thereof.* "What remains on both sides of the sacred portion and the city property will belong to the prince. It will extend eastward from the twenty-five thousand cubits of the sacred portion to the eastern border, and westward from the twenty-five thousand cubits to the western border. Both of these areas running the length of the tribal portions will belong to the prince, and the sacred portion with the temple sanctuary will be in the center."
- 22 *Moreover from the possession of the Levites, and from the possession of the city, being in the midst of that which is the prince's, between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin, shall be for the prince.* "So the property of the Levites and the property of the city will lie in the center of the area that belongs to the prince. The area belonging to the prince will lie between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin."
- 23 *As for the rest of the tribes, from the east side unto the west side, Benjamin shall have a portion.* "As for the rest of the tribes: Benjamin will have one portion from the east side to the west side."
- 24 *And by the border of Benjamin, from the east side unto the west side, Simeon shall have a portion.* "Adjoining the territory of Benjamin from east to west, Simeon will have one portion."
- 25 *And by the border of Simeon, from the east side unto the west side, Issachar a portion.* "Adjoining the territory of Simeon from east to west, Issachar will have one portion."
- 26 *And by the border of Issachar, from the east side unto the west side, Zebulun a portion.* "Adjoining the territory of Issachar from east to west, Zebulun will have one portion."
- 27 *And by the border of Zebulun, from the east side unto the west side, Gad a portion.* "Adjoining the territory of Zebulun from east to west, Gad will have one portion."

- 28 *And by the border of Gad, at the south side southward, the border shall be even from Tamar unto the waters of strife in Kadesh, and to the river toward the great sea.* "The southern boundary of Gad will run south from Tamar to the waters of Meribah Kadesh, then along the Wadi of Egypt to the Mediterranean Sea."
- 29 *This is the land which ye shall divide by lot unto the tribes of Israel, and these are their portions, saith the Lord GOD.* "This is the land You are to allot as an inheritance to the tribes of Israel, and these are their portions, declares the Lord GOD."
- 30 *And these are the goings out of the city on the north side, four thousand and five hundred measures.* "These are the exits of the city: Beginning on the north side, which is 4,500 cubits long —"
- 31 *And the gates of the city shall be after the names of the tribes of Israel: three gates northward; the gate of Reuben, one; the gate of Judah, one; the gate of Levi, one.* "the three gates on the north side will be named after the tribes of Israel: the gate of Reuben, the gate of Judah, and the gate of Levi."
- 32 *And at the east side four thousand and five hundred: and three gates; and one gate of Joseph, one gate of Benjamin, one gate of Dan.* "On the east side, which is 4,500 cubits long, will be three gates: the gate of Joseph, the gate of Benjamin, and the gate of Dan."
- 33 *And at the south side four thousand and five hundred measures: and three gates; one gate of Simeon, one gate of Issachar, one gate of Zebulun.* "On the south side, which is 4,500 cubits long, will be three gates: the gate of Simeon, the gate of Issachar, and the gate of Zebulun."
- 34 *At the west side four thousand and five hundred, with their three gates; one gate of Gad, one gate of Asher, one gate of Naphtali.* "On the west side, which is 4,500 cubits long, will be three gates: the gate of Gad, the gate of Asher, and the gate of Naphtali."
- 35 *It was round about eighteen thousand measures: and the name of the city from that day shall be, The LORD is there.* "The total circumference of the city will be 18,000 cubits. And the name of the city from that time on will be: THE LORD IS THERE."

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Naphtali (*NAF-tah-ly*) — Jacob's sixth son, by Bilhah — his tribe settled in Galilee near the Sea of Galilee; his name means 'my wrestling.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

v10 — Ezek 45:4

v11 — Ezek 44:10; Ezek 40:46

v14 — Lev 27:28

v35 — Rev 21:3; Zech 2:10; Rev 22:3; Jer 33:16; Isa 12:6

Daniel

THE BABYLONIAN PERIOD BEGINS — 605 BC

Author: *Daniel* — the book is written partly in third person (chs. 1–6) and partly in first person (chs. 7–12); Christ Himself refers to "Daniel the prophet" (Matt 24:15), confirming his authorship.

Date written: c. 605–535 BC, spanning Daniel's entire career from captivity under Nebuchadnezzar to the early reign of Cyrus.

Written to: The Jewish exiles in Babylon and the scattered nation of Israel, to encourage faithfulness under foreign domination and to reveal God's plan for the ages.

Setting: Daniel is taken to Babylon as a youth in the first deportation (605 BC). He rises to high office in the Babylonian and then Persian courts, living as a faithful Jew among the most powerful empires in the world. He writes during the very period when the fate of nations is being decided.

Where this sits historically: Spans c. 605–535 BC under Nebuchadnezzar, Belshazzar, Darius the Mede, and Cyrus the Great — the rise and fall of the Neo-Babylonian empire and the dawn of the Medo-Persian empire that would let Israel return.

Contemporaries: Ezekiel ministered to the exiles by the river Chebar in Daniel's same lifetime, while Jeremiah prophesied (and then died) back in Judah and Egypt, and Cyrus's decree (538 BC) launched the return that Haggai and Zechariah would soon address.

Big themes:

- Faithfulness under pressure — Daniel, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego all face death rather than compromise; God is faithful to those who are faithful to Him
- God rules the kingdoms of men — Nebuchadnezzar's dream, his madness, Belshazzar's feast, and the succession of empires all demonstrate that no earthly king holds power apart from God
- Apocalyptic prophecy — the second half of Daniel contains visions of four world empires, a coming prince, the abomination of desolation, and the resurrection of the dead
- The Son of man — Daniel 7:13–14 contains the clearest OT vision of the Messiah receiving an everlasting kingdom; Jesus used this title for Himself
- Prayer — Daniel prays three times daily facing Jerusalem (6:10); his prayer in chapter 9 is the model of intercessory confession

Key passages: Dan 2:44; 3:17–18; 6:10; 7:13–14; 9:24

How it fits: Daniel bridges the exile and restoration periods. His seventy-weeks prophecy (ch. 9) is the OT's most precise messianic timetable. Jesus quoted Daniel in the Olivet Discourse; Revelation draws on Daniel's imagery throughout. Without Daniel, much of NT prophecy is inexplicable.

Chapter 1

Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem and carried off young men of Judah's nobility to serve in Babylon's court. Daniel and his three friends refused the king's food, ate only vegetables and water, and God gave them knowledge and wisdom ten times greater than all the magicians in the kingdom.

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| 1 | <i>In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim king of Judah came Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon unto Jerusalem, and besieged it.</i> | In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim king of Judah, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to Jerusalem and besieged it. |
| 2 | <i>And the Lord gave Jehoiakim king of Judah into his hand, with part of the vessels of the house of God: which he carried into the land of Shinar to the house of his god; and he brought the vessels into the treasure house of his god.</i> | The Lord gave Jehoiakim king of Judah into his hand, along with some of the articles from the house of God. He carried these to the land of Shinar, to the house of His god, and placed the articles in the treasury of His god. |
| 3 | <i>And the king spake unto Ashpenaz the master of his eunuchs, that he should bring certain of the children of Israel, and of the king's seed, and of the princes;</i> | The king told Ashpenaz, the chief of his court officials, to bring some of the people of Israel — those from the royal family and the nobility — |
| 4 | <i>Children in whom was no blemish, but well favoured, and skilful in all wisdom, and cunning in knowledge, and understanding science, and such as had ability in them to stand in the king's palace, and whom they might teach the learning and the tongue of the Chaldeans.</i> | young men without any physical defect, handsome, skilled in all wisdom, knowledgeable, quick to understand, and able to serve in the king's palace. He wanted them taught the language and literature of the Babylonians. |
| 5 | <i>And the king appointed them a daily provision of the king's meat, and of the wine which he drank: so nourishing them three years, that at the end thereof they might stand before the king.</i> | The king assigned them a daily portion of his own food and wine. They were to be trained for three years, after which they would serve before the king. |

- 6 *Now among these were of the children of Judah, Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah:* Among those chosen were Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah — all from the tribe of Judah.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Daniel** (DAN-yel) — "God is my judge" — A young man from the tribe of Judah taken captive to Babylon. He became one of the greatest prophets of the Old Testament, known for his faithfulness to God under intense pressure.

- 7 *Unto whom the prince of the eunuchs gave names: for he gave unto Daniel the name of Belteshazzar; and to Hananiah, of Shadrach; and to Mishaël, of Meshach; and to Azariah, of Abednego.* The chief official gave them new names. Daniel he called Belteshazzar, Hananiah he called Shadrach, Mishaël he called Meshach, and Azariah he called Abednego.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hananiah** / **Shadrach** (hah-NAY-nee-ah / SHAY-drak) — Hananiah means "the LORD is gracious." He was given the Babylonian name Shadrach, a pagan name honoring a Babylonian god. He is one of the three Hebrew men thrown into the fiery furnace.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mishaël** / **Meshach** (MISH-ay-el / MEE-shak) — Mishaël means "Who is what God is?" He was given the Babylonian name Meshach. One of Daniel's three faithful companions.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Azariah** / **Abednego** (az-ah-RY-ah / ah-BED-nee-go) — Azariah means "the LORD has helped." He was given the Babylonian name Abednego, meaning "servant of Nebo," a Babylonian idol. One of Daniel's three faithful companions.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nebuchadnezzar** (neb-uh-kad-NEZ-er) — A Babylonian name meaning "may Nebo protect the boundary." He was the most powerful king of the Neo-Babylonian Empire, who conquered Jerusalem and carried Israel into captivity.

- 8 *But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king's meat, nor with the wine which he drank: therefore he requested of the prince of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself.* Daniel made up his mind that he would not defile himself with the king's food or wine. He asked the chief official for permission not to defile himself this way.
- 9 *Now God had brought Daniel into favour and tender love with the prince of the eunuchs.* God caused the chief official to show Daniel kindness and goodwill.

- 10 *And the prince of the eunuchs said unto Daniel, I fear my lord the king, who hath appointed your meat and your drink: for why should he see your faces worse liking than the children which are of your sort? then shall ye make me endanger my head to the king.* The chief official told Daniel, "I am afraid of my lord the king, who assigned your food and drink. If he sees that you look worse than the other young men your age, it will cost me my head before the king."
- 11 *Then said Daniel to Melzar, whom the prince of the eunuchs had set over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah,* Daniel then spoke to the steward whom the chief official had placed over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah.
- 12 *Prove thy servants, I beseech thee, ten days; and let them give us pulse to eat, and water to drink.* "Please test us for ten days," he said. "Give us only vegetables to eat and water to drink."
- 13 *Then let our countenances be looked upon before thee, and the countenance of the children that eat of the portion of the king's meat: and as thou seest, deal with thy servants.* Then compare our appearance with the young men who eat the king's food, and treat us according to what you see.
- 14 *So he consented to them in this matter, and proved them ten days.* The steward agreed to this and tested them for ten days.
- 15 *And at the end of ten days their countenances appeared fairer and fatter in flesh than all the children which did eat the portion of the king's meat.* At the end of ten days, Daniel and his friends looked healthier and better nourished than all the young men who ate the king's food.
- 16 *Thus Melzar took away the portion of their meat, and the wine that they should drink; and gave them pulse.* So the steward took away their portion of food and wine and gave them vegetables instead.
- 17 *As for these four children, God gave them knowledge and skill in all learning and wisdom: and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.* God gave these four young men knowledge and skill in all literature and learning. Daniel also had the ability to understand all kinds of visions and dreams.

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| <p>18 <i>Now at the end of the days that the king had said he should bring them in, then the prince of the eunuchs brought them in before Nebuchadnezzar.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the king communed with them; and among them all was found none like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah: therefore stood they before the king.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And in all matters of wisdom and understanding, that the king enquired of them, he found them ten times better than all the magicians and astrologers that were in all his realm.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And Daniel continued even unto the first year of king Cyrus.</i></p> | <p>When the time set by the king was over, the chief official brought them before Nebuchadnezzar.</p> <p>The king spoke with them, and he found none equal to Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah. So they entered the king's service.</p> <p>In every matter of wisdom and understanding that the king asked them about, he found them ten times better than all the magicians and enchanters in his entire kingdom.</p> <p>Daniel remained there until the first year of King Cyrus.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Chr 36:5-7; 2 Kgs 24:1-2; 2 Kgs 24:13
v2 — 2 Chr 36:7; Jer 27:19-20; Zech 5:11; Deut 32:30
v3 — Isa 39:7
v4 — Acts 7:22; Dan 5:11; Prov 22:29

v5 — Dan 1:19

v7 — Dan 5:12; Dan 4:8; Dan 2:49

v8 — Ps 141:4; 1 Cor 10:18-21; Ezek 4:13-14; Lev 11:45-47; 1 Cor 7:37

v9 — Gen 39:21; Ps 106:46; Prov 16:7; 1 Kgs 8:50; Neh 2:4

v15 — Ex 23:25

v17 — 1 Kgs 3:12; Jas 1:5; Job 32:8; Dan 2:21; Dan 2:23

v20 — Isa 47:12-14; 1 Kgs 4:29-34; Ex 8:19

v21 — Dan 6:28; Dan 10:1

Chapter 2

Nebuchadnezzar demanded his wise men tell him his dream and its meaning, or die. Daniel prayed, and God revealed the vision: a great statue with a head of gold, chest of silver, belly of bronze, legs of iron, and feet of iron mixed with clay. A stone cut without hands struck the statue, destroyed it, and became a great mountain filling the whole earth.

- 1 *And in the second year of the reign of Nebuchadnezzar Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams, wherewith his spirit was troubled, and his sleep brake from him.* In the second year of Nebuchadnezzar's reign, he had dreams that troubled his spirit and kept him from sleeping.
- 2 *Then the king commanded to call the magicians, and the astrologers, and the sorcerers, and the Chaldeans, for to shew the king his dreams. So they came and stood before the king.* The king summoned the magicians, enchanters, sorcerers, and astrologers to tell him what he had dreamed. They came and stood before the king.
- 3 *And the king said unto them, I have dreamed a dream, and my spirit was troubled to know the dream.* The king told them, "I have had a dream that troubles me, and I must know what it means."
- 4 *Then spake the Chaldeans to the king in Syriack, O king, live for ever: tell thy servants the dream, and we will shew the interpretation.* The astrologers answered the king in Aramaic: "O king, live forever! Tell your servants the dream, and we will interpret it."
- 5 *The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, The thing is gone from me: if ye will not make known unto me the dream, with the interpretation thereof, ye shall be cut in pieces, and your houses shall be made a dunghill.* The king replied to the astrologers, "This is what I have firmly decided: if you do not tell me what my dream was and interpret it, I will have you cut to pieces and your houses turned into rubble."

- 6 *But if ye shew the dream, and the interpretation thereof, ye shall receive of me gifts and rewards and great honour: therefore shew me the dream, and the interpretation thereof.* "But if you tell me the dream and its interpretation, you will receive gifts, rewards, and great honor from me. So tell me the dream and its interpretation."
- 7 *They answered again and said, Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will shew the interpretation of it.* They answered again, "Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will give the interpretation."
- 8 *The king answered and said, I know of certainty that ye would gain the time, because ye see the thing is gone from me.* The king replied, "I know for certain that you are trying to gain time, because you see that my decision is firm."
- 9 *But if ye will not make known unto me the dream, there is but one decree for you: for ye have prepared lying and corrupt words to speak before me, till the time be changed: therefore tell me the dream, and I shall know that ye can shew me the interpretation thereof.* "If you do not tell me the dream, there is only one punishment for you. You have agreed to lie to me in hopes that the situation will change. Tell me the dream, and then I will know that you can interpret it."
- 10 *The Chaldeans answered before the king, and said, There is not a man upon the earth that can shew the king's matter: therefore there is no king, lord, nor ruler, that asked such things at any magician, or astrologer, or Chaldean.* The astrologers answered the king, "There is no one on earth who can do what the king asks. No king, however great and powerful, has ever asked such a thing of any magician, enchanter, or astrologer."
- 11 *And it is a rare thing that the king requireth, and there is none other that can shew it before the king, except the gods, whose dwelling is not with flesh.* "What the king asks is too difficult. No one can reveal it to the king except the gods, and they do not live among men."
- 12 *For this cause the king was angry and very furious, and commanded to destroy all the wise men of Babylon.* Because of this, the king was enraged and furious. He ordered the execution of all the wise men of Babylon.

- 13 *And the decree went forth that the wise men should be slain; and they sought Daniel and his fellows to be slain.* The decree was issued for the wise men to be put to death, and men were sent to find Daniel and his friends to kill them as well.
- 14 *Then Daniel answered with counsel and wisdom to Arioch the captain of the king's guard, which was gone forth to slay the wise men of Babylon:* Daniel spoke wisely and carefully to Arioch, the commander of the king's guard, who had gone out to execute the wise men of Babylon.
- 15 *He answered and said to Arioch the king's captain, Why is the decree so hasty from the king? Then Arioch made the thing known to Daniel.* He asked Arioch, "Why has the king issued such a harsh decree?" Arioch then explained the matter to Daniel.
- 16 *Then Daniel went in, and desired of the king that he would give him time, and that he would shew the king the interpretation.* Daniel went to the king and asked for time, promising to give the king the interpretation.
- 17 *Then Daniel went to his house, and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions:* Daniel returned home and told Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah about the matter.
- 18 *That they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret; that Daniel and his fellows should not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.* He urged them to plead for mercy from the God of heaven about this mystery, so that He and His friends would not be executed with the rest of Babylon's wise men.
- 19 *Then was the secret revealed unto Daniel in a night vision. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven.* During the night, the mystery was revealed to Daniel in a vision. Then Daniel praised the God of heaven.
- 20 *Daniel answered and said, Blessed be the name of God for ever and ever: for wisdom and might are his:* Daniel said: "Praise be to the name of God forever and ever. Wisdom and power are His.

- 21 *And he changeth the times and the seasons: he removeth kings, and setteth up kings: he giveth wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to them that know understanding:* He changes times and seasons. He removes kings and sets up kings. He gives wisdom to the wise and knowledge to those with understanding.
- 22 *He revealeth the deep and secret things: he knoweth what is in the darkness, and the light dwelleth with him.* He reveals deep and hidden things. He knows what lies in darkness, and light dwells with Him.
- 23 *I thank thee, and praise thee, O thou God of my fathers, who hast given me wisdom and might, and hast made known unto me now what we desired of thee: for thou hast now made known unto us the king's matter.* I thank You and praise You, O God of my fathers. You have given me wisdom and strength. You have made known to me what we asked of You — You have made known to us the king's dream."
- 24 *Therefore Daniel went in unto Arioch, whom the king had ordained to destroy the wise men of Babylon: he went and said thus unto him; Destroy not the wise men of Babylon: bring me in before the king, and I will shew unto the king the interpretation.* Then Daniel went to Arioch, whom the king had appointed to execute the wise men of Babylon. "Do not execute the wise men," Daniel told him. "Bring me before the king and I will interpret the dream for him."
- 25 *Then Arioch brought in Daniel before the king in haste, and said thus unto him, I have found a man of the captives of Judah, that will make known unto the king the interpretation.* Arioch quickly brought Daniel before the king and said, "I have found a man among the exiles from Judah who can tell the king the interpretation."
- 26 *The king answered and said to Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, Art thou able to make known unto me the dream which I have seen, and the interpretation thereof?* The king asked Daniel, whose Babylonian name was Belteshazzar, "Are you able to tell me what I dreamed and what it means?"

- 27 *Daniel answered in the presence of the king, and said, The secret which the king hath demanded cannot the wise men, the astrologers, the magicians, the soothsayers, shew unto the king;* Daniel replied, "No wise man, enchanter, magician, or diviner can explain to the king the mystery he has asked about.
- 28 *But there is a God in heaven that revealeth secrets, and maketh known to the king Nebuchadnezzar what shall be in the latter days. Thy dream, and the visions of thy head upon thy bed, are these;* But there is a God in heaven who reveals mysteries. He has shown King Nebuchadnezzar what will happen in the days to come. Your dream and the visions you had while lying in bed are these:
- 29 *As for thee, O king, thy thoughts came into thy mind upon thy bed, what should come to pass hereafter: and he that revealeth secrets maketh known to thee what shall come to pass.* As you lay in bed, O king, your thoughts turned to things that are to come, and the Revealer of mysteries showed you what will happen.
- 30 *But as for me, this secret is not revealed to me for any wisdom that I have more than any living, but for their sakes that shall make known the interpretation to the king, and that thou mightest know the thoughts of thy heart.* This mystery has not been revealed to me because I have greater wisdom than anyone else. It has been revealed so that you, O king, may know the interpretation and understand the thoughts of your heart."
- 31 *Thou, O king, sawest, and behold a great image. This great image, whose brightness was excellent, stood before thee; and the form thereof was terrible.* "O king, you saw a great statue. It was enormous, brilliant, and awe-inspiring as it stood before you.
- 32 *This image's head was of fine gold, his breast and his arms of silver, his belly and his thighs of brass,* Its head was made of pure gold, its chest and arms of silver, its belly and thighs of bronze,
- 33 *His legs of iron, his feet part of iron and part of clay.* its legs of iron, and its feet partly of iron and partly of baked clay.

- 34 *Thou sawest till that a stone was cut out without hands, which smote the image upon his feet that were of iron and clay, and brake them to pieces.* While you were watching, a stone was cut out — but not by human hands. It struck the statue on its feet of iron and clay and crushed them.
- 35 *Then was the iron, the clay, the brass, the silver, and the gold, broken to pieces together, and became like the chaff of the summer threshingfloors; and the wind carried them away, that no place was found for them: and the stone that smote the image became a great mountain, and filled the whole earth.* Then the iron, clay, bronze, silver, and gold were all crushed together and became like chaff on a summer threshing floor. The wind swept them away without leaving a trace. But the stone that struck the statue became a great mountain and filled the whole earth.
- 36 *This is the dream; and we will tell the interpretation thereof before the king.* That was the dream. Now we will tell the king its interpretation.
- 37 *Thou, O king, art a king of kings: for the God of heaven hath given thee a kingdom, power, and strength, and glory.* You, O king, are a king of kings. The God of heaven has given you dominion, power, strength, and glory.
- 38 *And wheresoever the children of men dwell, the beasts of the field and the fowls of the heaven hath he given into thine hand, and hath made thee ruler over them all. Thou art this head of gold.* In your hands He has placed all mankind, the animals of the field, and the birds of the air. He has made you ruler over them all. You are that head of gold.
- 39 *And after thee shall arise another kingdom inferior to thee, and another third kingdom of brass, which shall bear rule over all the earth.* After you, another kingdom will arise, inferior to yours. Next, a third kingdom — one of bronze — will rule over the whole earth.
- 40 *And the fourth kingdom shall be strong as iron: forasmuch as iron breaketh in pieces and subdueth all things: and as iron that breaketh all these, shall it break in pieces and bruise.* Finally, there will be a fourth kingdom, strong as iron. Just as iron breaks and crushes everything, this kingdom will crush and break all the others.

- 41 *And whereas thou sawest the feet and toes, part of potters' clay, and part of iron, the kingdom shall be divided; but there shall be in it of the strength of the iron, forasmuch as thou sawest the iron mixed with miry clay.* The feet and toes you saw — partly of baked clay and partly of iron — mean that this kingdom will be divided. It will have some of the strength of iron, since you saw iron mixed with clay.
- 42 *And as the toes of the feet were part of iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom shall be partly strong, and partly broken.* As the toes were partly iron and partly clay, the kingdom will be partly strong and partly brittle.
- 43 *And whereas thou sawest iron mixed with miry clay, they shall mingle themselves with the seed of men: but they shall not cleave one to another, even as iron is not mixed with clay.* As you saw iron mixed with clay, so people will mix, but they will not remain united, just as iron does not mix with clay.
- 44 *And in the days of these kings shall the God of heaven set up a kingdom, which shall never be destroyed: and the kingdom shall not be left to other people, but it shall break in pieces and consume all these kingdoms, and it shall stand for ever.* In the time of those kings, the God of heaven will set up a kingdom that will never be destroyed. It will not be left to another people. It will crush all those kingdoms and bring them to an end, but it will itself endure forever.
- 45 *Forasmuch as thou sawest that the stone was cut out of the mountain without hands, and that it brake in pieces the iron, the brass, the clay, the silver, and the gold; the great God hath made known to the king what shall come to pass hereafter: and the dream is certain, and the interpretation thereof sure.* This is the meaning of the stone cut from the mountain — not by human hands — that broke the iron, bronze, clay, silver, and gold to pieces. The great God has shown the king what will take place in the future. The dream is true, and its interpretation is reliable."

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| <p>46 <i>Then the king Nebuchadnezzar fell upon his face, and worshipped Daniel, and commanded that they should offer an oblation and sweet odours unto him.</i></p> <p>47 <i>The king answered unto Daniel, and said, Of a truth it is, that your God is a God of gods, and a Lord of kings, and a revealer of secrets, seeing thou couldest reveal this secret.</i></p> <p>48 <i>Then the king made Daniel a great man, and gave him many great gifts, and made him ruler over the whole province of Babylon, and chief of the governors over all the wise men of Babylon.</i></p> <p>49 <i>Then Daniel requested of the king, and he set Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, over the affairs of the province of Babylon: but Daniel sat in the gate of the king.</i></p> | <p>Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell prostrate before Daniel and ordered that an offering and incense be presented to him.</p> <p>The king said to Daniel, "Truly your God is the God of gods, the Lord of kings, and a Revealer of mysteries, for you were able to reveal this mystery."</p> <p>Then the king elevated Daniel to a high position and lavished many gifts on him. He made him ruler over the entire province of Babylon and placed him in charge of all its wise men.</p> <p>At Daniel's request, the king appointed Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego to oversee the affairs of the province of Babylon. Daniel himself remained at the royal court.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Dan 1:20; Dan 4:6; Gen 41:8; Ex 7:11
v4 — Ezra 4:7; Dan 5:10; Dan 3:9
v19 — Num 12:6; Amos 3:7; Dan 1:17; Ps 25:14; Job 33:15-16
v20 — Ps 113:2; Ps 145:1-2; Job 12:13; Rev 5:12; Ps 147:5
v21 — Ps 75:5-7; Ps 31:14-15; Ps 113:7-8; Dan 4:17; Dan 7:25
v22 — Job 12:22; 1 John 1:5; Jer 23:24; Jas 1:17; Heb 4:13
v23 — Dan 2:18; Ex 3:15; Amos 3:7; Dan 2:20-21; Dan 2:29-30
v28 — Gen 40:8; Dan 10:14; Amos 4:13; Gen 49:1; Dan 2:22
v34 — Dan 2:44-45; Dan 8:25; Zech 12:3; Zech 4:6; Isa 60:12
v44 — Luke 1:32-33; Matt 28:18; Ps 145:13; Dan 6:26; Rev 11:15
v46 — Acts 10:25; Ezra 6:10; Acts 14:13

v47 — Dan 2:22; Dan 2:28; Amos 3:7

Chapter 3

Nebuchadnezzar set up a golden image and commanded all to bow down to it. Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego refused and were cast into a fiery furnace heated seven times hotter — but a fourth figure appeared with them in the fire, and they came out without even the smell of smoke on them.

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| <p>1 <i>Nebuchadnezzar the king made an image of gold, whose height was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof six cubits: he set it up in the plain of Dura, in the province of Babylon.</i></p> | <p>King Nebuchadnezzar made a gold statue ninety feet tall and nine feet wide and set it up on the plain of Dura in the province of Babylon.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to gather together the princes, the governors, and the captains, the judges, the treasurers, the counsellors, the sheriffs, and all the rulers of the provinces, to come to the dedication of the image which Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up.</i></p> | <p>He then sent word to gather the satraps, prefects, governors, advisers, treasurers, judges, magistrates, and all the other provincial officials to come to the dedication of the statue he had set up.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then the princes, the governors, and captains, the judges, the treasurers, the counsellors, the sheriffs, and all the rulers of the provinces, were gathered together unto the dedication of the image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up; and they stood before the image that Nebuchadnezzar had set up.</i></p> | <p>So the satraps, prefects, governors, advisers, treasurers, judges, magistrates, and all the other provincial officials assembled for the dedication of the statue, and they stood before it.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then an herald cried aloud, To you it is commanded, O people, nations, and languages,</i></p> | <p>Then a herald called out loudly, "People of every nation and language, this is what you are commanded:</p> |

- 5 *That at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king hath set up:* As soon as you hear the sound of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipes, and all kinds of music, fall down and worship the gold statue that King Nebuchadnezzar has set up.
- 6 *And whoso falleth not down and worshippeth shall the same hour be cast into the midst of a burning fiery furnace.* Anyone who does not fall down and worship will immediately be thrown into a blazing furnace."
- 7 *Therefore at that time, when all the people heard the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and all kinds of musick, all the people, the nations, and the languages, fell down and worshipped the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up.* When the music played, all the peoples, nations, and men of every language fell down and worshipped the gold statue that King Nebuchadnezzar had set up.
- 8 *Wherefore at that time certain Chaldeans came near, and accused the Jews.* At this time some astrologers came forward and denounced the Jews.
- 9 *They spake and said to the king Nebuchadnezzar, O king, live for ever.* They said to King Nebuchadnezzar, "O king, live forever!
- 10 *Thou, O king, hast made a decree, that every man that shall hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, shall fall down and worship the golden image:* You have issued a decree, O king, that everyone who hears the music must fall down and worship the gold statue.
- 11 *And whoso falleth not down and worshippeth, that he should be cast into the midst of a burning fiery furnace.* Anyone who does not fall down and worship is to be thrown into a blazing furnace.

- 12 *There are certain Jews whom thou hast set over the affairs of the province of Babylon, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego; these men, O king, have not regarded thee: they serve not thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up.* But there are some Jews you have appointed over the affairs of Babylon — Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego — who pay no attention to you, O king. They do not serve your gods and will not worship the gold statue you have set up."
- 13 *Then Nebuchadnezzar in his rage and fury commanded to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Then they brought these men before the king.* Furious with rage, Nebuchadnezzar ordered Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego to be brought before him.
- 14 *Nebuchadnezzar spake and said unto them, Is it true, O Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, do not ye serve my gods, nor worship the golden image which I have set up?* Nebuchadnezzar said to them, "Is it true, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, that you do not serve my gods or worship the gold statue I have set up?"
- 15 *Now if ye be ready that at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the image which I have made; well: but if ye worship not, ye shall be cast the same hour into the midst of a burning fiery furnace; and who is that God that shall deliver you out of my hands?* Now, if you are ready to fall down and worship the statue I made when you hear the music, very good. But if you do not worship it, you will be thrown immediately into a blazing furnace. Then what god will be able to rescue you from my hand?"
- 16 *Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, answered and said to the king, O Nebuchadnezzar, we are not careful to answer thee in this matter.* Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego replied to the king, "O Nebuchadnezzar, we do not need to defend ourselves before you in this matter.
- 17 *If it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of thine hand, O king.* If we are thrown into the blazing furnace, the God we serve is able to deliver us from it, and He will rescue us from your hand, O king.

- 18 *But if not, be it known unto thee, O king, that we will not serve thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up.* But even if He does not, know this, O king: we will not serve your gods or worship the gold statue you have set up."
- 19 *Then was Nebuchadnezzar full of fury, and the form of his visage was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego: therefore he spake, and commanded that they should heat the furnace one seven times more than it was wont to be heated.* Nebuchadnezzar was filled with rage, and the expression on his face changed toward Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. He ordered the furnace heated seven times hotter than usual.
- 20 *And he commanded the most mighty men that were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace.* He commanded some of the strongest soldiers in his army to tie up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego and throw them into the blazing furnace.
- 21 *Then these men were bound in their coats, their hosen, and their hats, and their other garments, and were cast into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.* So these men were bound in their robes, tunics, turbans, and other clothes, and thrown into the blazing furnace.
- 22 *Therefore because the king's commandment was urgent, and the furnace exceeding hot, the flame of the fire slew those men that took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego.* Because the king's order was so urgent and the furnace so hot, the flames killed the soldiers who threw Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego into it.
- 23 *And these three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, fell down bound into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.* And the three men — Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego — fell, still tied up, into the blazing furnace.

- 24 *Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was astonied, and rose up in haste, and spake, and said unto his counsellors, Did not we cast three men bound into the midst of the fire? They answered and said unto the king, True, O king.* King Nebuchadnezzar leaped to his feet in amazement and asked his advisers, "Didn't we throw three men into the fire?" They replied, "Certainly, O king."
- 25 *He answered and said, Lo, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God.* He said, "Look! I see four men walking around in the fire, unbound and unharmed, and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God."
- 26 *Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to the mouth of the burning fiery furnace, and spake, and said, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, ye servants of the most high God, come forth, and come hither. Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, came forth of the midst of the fire.* Nebuchadnezzar approached the opening of the blazing furnace and called, "Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, servants of the Most High God, come out! Come here!" So Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego came out of the fire.
- 27 *And the princes, governors, and captains, and the king's counsellors, being gathered together, saw these men, upon whose bodies the fire had no power, nor was an hair of their head singed, neither were their coats changed, nor the smell of fire had passed on them.* The satraps, prefects, governors, and royal advisers crowded around and saw that the fire had not harmed them. Not a hair on their heads was singed, their robes were not scorched, and there was no smell of fire on them.
- 28 *Then Nebuchadnezzar spake, and said, Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who hath sent his angel, and delivered his servants that trusted in him, and have changed the king's word, and yielded their bodies, that they might not serve nor worship any god, except their own God.* Nebuchadnezzar said, "Praise be to the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who has sent His angel and rescued His servants! They trusted in him and defied the king's command. They chose to give up their bodies rather than serve or worship any god except their own God."

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| <p>29 <i>Therefore I make a decree, That every people, nation, and language, which speak any thing amiss against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill: because there is no other God that can deliver after this sort.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Then the king promoted Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, in the province of Babylon.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I decree that the people of any nation or language who say anything against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego shall be cut to pieces and their houses turned into rubble. No other god can save in this way.</p> <p>Then the king promoted Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego in the province of Babylon.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Nebuchadnezzar (*neb-yoo-kud-NEZ-er*) — King of Babylon who destroyed Jerusalem and took the Jews into exile — later humbled by God and acknowledged God's sovereignty; his name means 'Nabu, protect my firstborn son.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hab 2:19; Jer 16:20; Isa 46:6; Hos 8:4; Acts 17:29
- v4 — Dan 4:1; Dan 6:25
- v5 — Dan 3:15; Dan 3:10
- v6 — Matt 13:42; Matt 13:50; Jer 29:22
- v12 — Dan 6:13; Dan 2:49
- v15 — Acts 5:29; Ex 5:2; Dan 3:17; 2 Chr 32:15-17; 2 Kgs 18:35
- v17 — Rom 8:31; Luke 1:37; Heb 7:25; Ps 27:1-2; Jer 1:8
- v18 — Acts 5:29-32; Matt 10:39; Rev 2:10-11; Matt 10:32-33; Luke 12:3-9
- v19 — Dan 3:13; Lev 26:24
- v25 — Isa 43:2; Acts 28:5; Mark 16:18; Ps 91:3-9; Ps 34:7
- v27 — Isa 43:2; Heb 11:34; Isa 26:11
- v28 — Rom 14:7-8; Ps 34:7-8; Ps 84:11-12; Ex 20:5; Rev 12:11

Chapter 4

Nebuchadnezzar dreamed of a great tree cut down by a watcher from heaven. Daniel interpreted: the king would be driven from men and live like an animal for seven times until he acknowledged that the Most High rules the kingdoms of men. It came to pass exactly as Daniel said, and afterward Nebuchadnezzar praised and honored the King of heaven.

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| 1 <i>Nebuchadnezzar the king, unto all people, nations, and languages, that dwell in all the earth; Peace be multiplied unto you.</i> | King Nebuchadnezzar, to all peoples, nations, and languages throughout the earth: May your peace be great! |
| 2 <i>I thought it good to shew the signs and wonders that the high God hath wrought toward me.</i> | It is my pleasure to tell You about the miraculous signs and wonders that the Most High God has performed for me. |
| 3 <i>How great are his signs! and how mighty are his wonders! his kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his dominion is from generation to generation.</i> | How great are His signs! How mighty His wonders! His kingdom is an eternal kingdom. His dominion lasts from generation to generation. |
| 4 <i>I Nebuchadnezzar was at rest in mine house, and flourishing in my palace:</i> | I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at home in my palace, living in comfort. |
| 5 <i>I saw a dream which made me afraid, and the thoughts upon my bed and the visions of my head troubled me.</i> | I had a dream that frightened me. As I lay in bed, the images and visions that passed through my mind terrified me. |
| 6 <i>Therefore made I a decree to bring in all the wise men of Babylon before me, that they might make known unto me the interpretation of the dream.</i> | So I commanded that all the wise men of Babylon be brought before me to interpret the dream. |
| 7 <i>Then came in the magicians, the astrologers, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers: and I told the dream before them; but they did not make known unto me the interpretation thereof.</i> | When the magicians, enchanters, astrologers, and diviners came, I told them the dream, but they could not interpret it for me. |
| 8 <i>But at the last Daniel came in before me, whose name was Belteshazzar, according to the name of my god, and in whom is the spirit of the holy gods: and before him I told the dream, saying,</i> | Finally, Daniel came before me — the one named Belteshazzar after my god, in whom is the spirit of the holy gods. I told Him the dream, saying, |

- 9 *O Belteshazzar, master of the magicians, because I know that the spirit of the holy gods is in thee, and no secret troubleth thee, tell me the visions of my dream that I have seen, and the interpretation thereof.* "Belteshazzar, chief of the magicians, I know that the spirit of the holy gods is in you and no mystery is too hard for you. Here is my dream. Tell me its interpretation.
- 10 *Thus were the visions of mine head in my bed; I saw, and behold a tree in the midst of the earth, and the height thereof was great.* These were the visions I had while lying in bed: I looked, and there was a tree in the middle of the land. It was very tall.
- 11 *The tree grew, and was strong, and the height thereof reached unto heaven, and the sight thereof to the end of all the earth:* The tree grew large and strong, and its top touched the sky. It was visible to the ends of the earth.
- 12 *The leaves thereof were fair, and the fruit thereof much, and in it was meat for all: the beasts of the field had shadow under it, and the fowls of the heaven dwelt in the branches thereof, and all flesh was fed of it.* Its leaves were beautiful, its fruit abundant, and it provided food for all. The wild animals rested in its shade and the birds lived in its branches. Every creature was fed from it.
- 13 *I saw in the visions of my head upon my bed, and, behold, a watcher and an holy one came down from heaven;* In the vision, while I lay in bed, I saw a watcher and an holy one come down from heaven.
- 14 *He cried aloud, and said thus, Hew down the tree, and cut off his branches, shake off his leaves, and scatter his fruit: let the beasts get away from under it, and the fowls from his branches:* He called out loudly: 'Cut down the tree and trim off its branches. Strip off its leaves and scatter its fruit. Let the animals flee from under it and the birds from its branches.

- 15 *Nevertheless leave the stump of his roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and brass, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let his portion be with the beasts in the grass of the earth:* But leave the stump and its roots in the ground, bound with iron and bronze, in the grass of the field. Let it be drenched with the dew of heaven. Let him live with the animals among the plants of the earth.
- 16 *Let his heart be changed from man's, and let a beast's heart be given unto him; and let seven times pass over him.* Let his mind be changed from that of a man and let him be given the mind of an animal, until seven times pass over him.'
- 17 *This matter is by the decree of the watchers, and the demand by the word of the holy ones: to the intent that the living may know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will, and setteth up over it the basest of men.* This sentence is decreed by the watchers, this decision by the holy ones. The purpose is that the living may know that the Most High rules over the kingdoms of men. He gives them to anyone he pleases and sets over them the lowliest of men."
- 18 *This dream I king Nebuchadnezzar have seen. Now thou, O Belteshazzar, declare the interpretation thereof, forasmuch as all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to make known unto me the interpretation: but thou art able; for the spirit of the holy gods is in thee.* "This is the dream that I, King Nebuchadnezzar, had. Now tell me its interpretation, Belteshazzar, because none of the wise men in my kingdom can interpret it. But you can, because the spirit of the holy gods is in you."
- 19 *Then Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, was astonished for one hour, and his thoughts troubled him. The king spake, and said, Belteshazzar, let not the dream, or the interpretation thereof, trouble thee. Belteshazzar answered and said, My lord, the dream be to them that hate thee, and the interpretation thereof to thine enemies.* Then Daniel, called Belteshazzar, was deeply troubled for a time, and his thoughts alarmed him. The king said, "Belteshazzar, do not let the dream or its interpretation alarm you." Daniel replied, "My lord, may the dream apply to your enemies and its meaning to your foes!

- 20 *The tree that thou sawest, which grew, and was strong, whose height reached unto the heaven, and the sight thereof to all the earth;* The tree you saw, which grew large and strong, with its top touching the sky, visible to the whole earth —
- 21 *Whose leaves were fair, and the fruit thereof much, and in it was meat for all; under which the beasts of the field dwelt, and upon whose branches the fowls of the heaven had their habitation:* whose leaves were beautiful and its fruit abundant, providing food for all, giving shelter to the wild animals and nesting places to the birds —
- 22 *It is thou, O king, that art grown and become strong: for thy greatness is grown, and reacheth unto heaven, and thy dominion to the end of the earth.* that tree is you, O king! You have grown great and strong. Your greatness has reached to the heavens, and your dominion extends to the ends of the earth.
- 23 *And whereas the king saw a watcher and an holy one coming down from heaven, and saying, Hew the tree down, and destroy it; yet leave the stump of the roots thereof in the earth, even with a band of iron and brass, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let his portion be with the beasts of the field, till seven times pass over him;* The king saw a watcher and an holy one coming down from heaven and saying, 'Cut down the tree and destroy it, but leave the stump and its roots in the ground, bound with iron and bronze in the grass of the field. Let him be drenched with dew and live with the animals until seven times pass over him.'
- 24 *This is the interpretation, O king, and this is the decree of the most High, which is come upon my lord the king:* This is the interpretation, O king. This is the decree the Most High has issued against my lord the king:

- 25 *That they shall drive thee from men, and thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field, and they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and they shall wet thee with the dew of heaven, and seven times shall pass over thee, till thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will.* You will be driven away from people and will live with the wild animals. You will eat grass like cattle and be drenched with the dew of heaven. Seven times will pass over You until You acknowledge that the Most High rules over the kingdoms of men and gives them to anyone he pleases.
- 26 *And whereas they commanded to leave the stump of the tree roots; thy kingdom shall be sure unto thee, after that thou shalt have known that the heavens do rule.* The command to leave the stump means that Your kingdom will be restored to You when You acknowledge that Heaven rules.
- 27 *Wherefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable unto thee, and break off thy sins by righteousness, and thine iniquities by shewing mercy to the poor; if it may be a lengthening of thy tranquillity.* Therefore, O king, please accept my advice. Break with Your sins by doing what is right, and put an end to Your iniquity by showing mercy to the poor. It may be that Your prosperity will continue."
- **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (in-*IK*-wih-tee) — "deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than 'sin' — the corruption beneath the sinful act." Where sin is missing the mark, iniquity is the warped nature that makes a person keep missing it.
- 28 *All this came upon the king Nebuchadnezzar.* All this happened to King Nebuchadnezzar.
- 29 *At the end of twelve months he walked in the palace of the kingdom of Babylon.* Twelve months later, he was walking on the roof of the royal palace of Babylon.
- 30 *The king spake, and said, Is not this great Babylon, that I have built for the house of the kingdom by the might of my power, and for the honour of my majesty?* He said, "Is not this great Babylon? I built it as the royal residence, by my mighty power and for the glory of my majesty."

- 31 *While the word was in the king's mouth, there fell a voice from heaven, saying, O king Nebuchadnezzar, to thee it is spoken; The kingdom is departed from thee.* Even as the words were on his lips, a voice came from heaven: "King Nebuchadnezzar, this is what is decreed for you: Your royal authority has been taken from you.
- 32 *And they shall drive thee from men, and thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field: they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and seven times shall pass over thee, until thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will.* You will be driven away from people and will live with the wild animals. You will eat grass like cattle. Seven times will pass over You until You acknowledge that the Most High rules over the kingdoms of men and gives them to anyone he pleases."
- 33 *The same hour was the thing fulfilled upon Nebuchadnezzar: and he was driven from men, and did eat grass as oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven, till his hairs were grown like eagles' feathers, and his nails like birds' claws.* Immediately that very hour the sentence was carried out. Nebuchadnezzar was driven away from people. He ate grass like cattle. His body was drenched with the dew of heaven until his hair grew like the feathers of an eagle and his nails like the claws of a bird.
- 34 *And at the end of the days I Nebuchadnezzar lifted up mine eyes unto heaven, and mine understanding returned unto me, and I blessed the most High, and I praised and honoured him that liveth for ever, whose dominion is an everlasting dominion, and his kingdom is from generation to generation:* At the end of that time I, Nebuchadnezzar, raised my eyes toward heaven, and my sanity was restored. Then I praised the Most High. I honored and glorified Him who lives forever. His dominion is an eternal dominion. His kingdom endures from generation to generation.
- 35 *And all the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing: and he doeth according to his will in the army of heaven, and among the inhabitants of the earth: and none can stay his hand, or say unto him, What doest thou?* All the peoples of the earth are regarded as nothing. He does as He pleases with the powers of heaven and the peoples of the earth. No one can hold back his hand or say to him, "What have You done?"

- 36 *At the same time my reason returned unto me; and for the glory of my kingdom, mine honour and brightness returned unto me; and my counsellors and my lords sought unto me; and I was established in my kingdom, and excellent majesty was added unto me.* At the same time my sanity returned. My honor and splendor were restored for the glory of my kingdom. My advisers and nobles came to me, and I was restored to my throne. I became even greater than before.
- 37 *Now I Nebuchadnezzar praise and extol and honour the King of heaven, all whose works are truth, and his ways judgment: and those that walk in pride he is able to abase.* Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise and exalt and glorify the King of heaven. Everything he does is right and all His ways are just. And those who walk in pride He is able to humble.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Daniel (DAN-yel) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Dan 6:25; Dan 3:4; 1 Pet 1:2
v2 — Dan 3:26; Ps 66:16
v3 — Ps 145:13; Isa 25:1; Dan 2:44; Dan 7:14; Rev 11:15
v9 — Dan 5:11; Dan 2:48; Dan 4:8
v10 — Jer 12:2; Dan 4:5
v11 — Deut 9:1; Dan 4:21-22; Matt 11:23
v17 — Dan 4:25; Dan 2:21; 1 Sam 2:8; Ps 75:6-7; Jer 27:5-7
v25 — Dan 4:17; Jer 27:5; Ps 83:18; Dan 2:21; Ps 106:20
v27 — Isa 55:6-7; Jonah 3:9; Acts 8:22; Ezek 18:27-32; Luke 11:41
v34 — Rev 4:10; Ps 145:13; Jer 10:10; Dan 2:44; Dan 12:7
v35 — Job 42:2; Ps 135:6; Ps 115:3; Rom 11:33-36; Isa 43:13
v37 — Jas 4:6-7; Ps 33:4-5; 1 Pet 5:5-6; 1 Sam 2:3; Deut 32:4

Chapter 5

King Belshazzar held a great feast using the golden vessels taken from the temple in Jerusalem. A hand appeared and wrote on the wall: MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN. Daniel interpreted the writing — God had numbered Belshazzar's kingdom and finished it, weighed him and found him wanting. That very night Belshazzar was slain and Darius the Mede took

the kingdom.

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| <p>1 <i>Belshazzar the king made a great feast to a thousand of his lords, and drank wine before the thousand.</i></p> | <p>King Belshazzar made a great feast for a thousand of his nobles and drank wine in their presence.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Belshazzar** (bel-SHAZ-er) — "Bel, protect the king" — Son of Nabonidus and co-regent of Babylon; grandson of Nebuchadnezzar. Slain the night Babylon fell to Persia.

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| <p>2 <i>Belshazzar, while he tasted the wine, commanded to bring the golden and silver vessels which his father Nebuchadnezzar had taken out of the temple which was in Jerusalem; that the king, and his princes, his wives, and his concubines, might drink therein.</i></p> | <p>While he was drinking the wine, Belshazzar gave orders to bring in the gold and silver vessels that his father Nebuchadnezzar had taken from the temple in Jerusalem, so that the king and his nobles, his wives and his concubines might drink from them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then they brought the golden vessels that were taken out of the temple of the house of God which was at Jerusalem; and the king, and his princes, his wives, and his concubines, drank in them.</i></p> | <p>So they brought the gold vessels that had been taken from the temple of the house of God in Jerusalem, and the king and his nobles, his wives and his concubines drank from them.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>They drank wine, and praised the gods of gold, and of silver, of brass, of iron, of wood, and of stone.</i></p> | <p>They drank wine and praised the gods of gold and silver, of bronze, iron, wood, and stone.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>In the same hour came forth fingers of a man's hand, and wrote over against the candlestick upon the plaster of the wall of the king's palace: and the king saw the part of the hand that wrote.</i></p> | <p>At that very moment, the fingers of a human hand appeared and wrote on the plaster of the wall near the lampstand in the royal palace. The king watched the hand as it wrote.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Then the king's countenance was changed, and his thoughts troubled him, so that the joints of his loins were loosed, and his knees smote one against another.</i></p> | <p>The king's countenance changed and his thoughts troubled him, so that his hip joints gave way and his knees knocked together.</p> |

- 7 *The king cried aloud to bring in the astrologers, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers. And the king spake, and said to the wise men of Babylon, Whosoever shall read this writing, and shew me the interpretation thereof, shall be clothed with scarlet, and have a chain of gold about his neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom.* The king called out to bring in the astrologers, the Chaldeans, and the diviners. He said to the wise men of Babylon, "Whoever reads this writing and tells me its interpretation shall be clothed in purple, have a gold chain placed around his neck, and be made the third highest ruler in the kingdom."
- 8 *Then came in all the king's wise men: but they could not read the writing, nor make known to the king the interpretation thereof.* All the king's wise men came in, but they could not read the writing or tell the king what it meant.
- 9 *Then was king Belshazzar greatly troubled, and his countenance was changed in him, and his lords were astonished.* So King Belshazzar was greatly troubled, and his countenance changed in him, and his nobles were baffled.
- 10 *Now the queen, by reason of the words of the king and his lords, came into the banquet house: and the queen spake and said, O king, live for ever: let not thy thoughts trouble thee, nor let thy countenance be changed:* The queen, hearing the voices of the king and his nobles, came into the banquet hall. She said, "O king, live forever! Do not let your thoughts trouble you or your countenance be changed.
- 11 *There is a man in thy kingdom, in whom is the spirit of the holy gods; and in the days of thy father light and understanding and wisdom, like the wisdom of the gods, was found in him; whom the king Nebuchadnezzar thy father, the king, I say, thy father, made master of the magicians, astrologers, Chaldeans, and soothsayers;* There is a man in your kingdom who has the spirit of the holy gods in Him. In the days of your father, this man was found to have light, understanding, and wisdom like the wisdom of the gods. King Nebuchadnezzar your father — your father the king — appointed him chief of the magicians, astrologers, Chaldeans, and diviners.

- 12 *Forasmuch as an excellent spirit, and knowledge, and understanding, interpreting of dreams, and shewing of hard sentences, and dissolving of doubts, were found in the same Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar: now let Daniel be called, and he will shew the interpretation.* This man Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar, was found to have a keen mind, knowledge, and understanding — able to interpret dreams, explain riddles, and solve difficult problems. Call for Daniel; he will tell you what this means."
- 13 *Then was Daniel brought in before the king. And the king spake and said unto Daniel, Art thou that Daniel, which art of the children of the captivity of Judah, whom the king my father brought out of Jewry?* So Daniel was brought before the king. The king said to him, "Are you that Daniel, one of the exiles my father the king brought from Judah?
- 14 *I have even heard of thee, that the spirit of the gods is in thee, and that light and understanding and excellent wisdom is found in thee.* I have heard that the spirit of the gods is in you and that you have insight, understanding, and outstanding wisdom.
- 15 *And now the wise men, the astrologers, have been brought in before me, that they should read this writing, and make known unto me the interpretation thereof: but they could not shew the interpretation of the thing:* The wise men and astrologers were brought before me to read this writing and tell me its meaning, but they could not give the interpretation.
- 16 *And I have heard of thee, that thou canst make interpretations, and dissolve doubts: now if thou canst read the writing, and make known to me the interpretation thereof, thou shalt be clothed with scarlet, and have a chain of gold about thy neck, and shalt be the third ruler in the kingdom.* I have heard that you are able to give interpretations and solve difficult problems. If you can read this writing and tell me what it means, you shall be clothed in purple, have a gold chain placed around your neck, and be made the third ruler in the kingdom."

- 17 *Then Daniel answered and said before the king, Let thy gifts be to thyself, and give thy rewards to another; yet I will read the writing unto the king, and make known to him the interpretation.* Daniel answered the king, "You may keep your gifts for yourself and give your rewards to someone else. Nevertheless, I will read the writing for the king and tell him what it means.
- 18 *O thou king, the most high God gave Nebuchadnezzar thy father a kingdom, and majesty, and glory, and honour:* O king, the Most High God gave Your father Nebuchadnezzar sovereignty and greatness and glory and splendor.
- 19 *And for the majesty that he gave him, all people, nations, and languages, trembled and feared before him: whom he would he slew; and whom he would he kept alive; and whom he would he set up; and whom he would he put down.* Because of the greatness He gave Him, all peoples, nations, and men of every language feared and trembled before Him. He put to death those He wanted to put to death; He spared those He wanted to spare; He promoted those He wanted to promote; He humbled those He wanted to humble.
- 20 *But when his heart was lifted up, and his mind hardened in pride, he was deposed from his kingly throne, and they took his glory from him:* But when His heart became proud and His spirit grew arrogant, He was deposed from His royal throne and stripped of His glory.
- 21 *And he was driven from the sons of men; and his heart was made like the beasts, and his dwelling was with the wild asses: they fed him with grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven; till he knew that the most high God ruled in the kingdom of men, and that he appointeth over it whomsoever he will.* He was driven away from people and given the mind of an animal. He lived with the wild donkeys, ate grass like cattle, and His body was drenched with the dew of heaven — until He acknowledged that the Most High God rules over the kingdoms of men and sets over them whoever he chooses.
- 22 *And thou his son, O Belshazzar, hast not humbled thine heart, though thou knewest all this;* But you, his son Belshazzar, have not humbled yourself, though you knew all this.

- 23 *But hast lifted up thyself against the Lord of heaven; and they have brought the vessels of his house before thee, and thou, and thy lords, thy wives, and thy concubines, have drunk wine in them; and thou hast praised the gods of silver, and gold, of brass, iron, wood, and stone, which see not, nor hear, nor know: and the God in whose hand thy breath is, and whose are all thy ways, hast thou not glorified:* Instead, you have set yourself up against the Lord of heaven. You had the vessels from His house brought to you, and you and your nobles, your wives and your concubines drank wine from them. You praised the gods of silver and gold, of bronze, iron, wood, and stone — which cannot see or hear or understand. But the God Who holds your very breath in His hand and controls all your ways — Him you have not honored.
- 24 *Then was the part of the hand sent from him; and this writing was written.* Therefore He sent the hand that wrote this inscription.
- 25 *And this is the writing that was written, MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.* This is the inscription that was written: MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.
- 26 *This is the interpretation of the thing: MENE; God hath numbered thy kingdom, and finished it.* This is what these words mean: MENE — God has numbered the days of your reign and brought it to an end.
- 27 *TEKEL; Thou art weighed in the balances, and art found wanting.* TEKEL — you have been weighed on the scales and found wanting.
- 28 *PERES; Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians.* PERES — your kingdom is divided and given to the Medes and Persians.
- 29 *Then commanded Belshazzar, and they clothed Daniel with scarlet, and put a chain of gold about his neck, and made a proclamation concerning him, that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom.* Then Belshazzar gave the command, and Daniel was clothed in purple, a gold chain was placed around his neck, and he was proclaimed the third highest ruler in the kingdom.
- 30 *In that night was Belshazzar the king of the Chaldeans slain.* That very night Belshazzar, king of the Chaldeans, was slain.

31 *And Darius the Median took the kingdom, being about threescore and two years old.* Darius the Mede took over the kingdom at the age of sixty-two.

Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Dan 1:2; 2 Kgs 24:13
- v4 — Dan 5:23; Hab 2:19; Ps 135:15-18
- v5 — Dan 4:31; Dan 5:24-28; Col 2:14; 1 Thess 5:2-3; Job 20:5
- v6 — Ezek 7:17; Dan 7:28; Nah 2:10
- v7 — Dan 5:16; Dan 5:29; Dan 2:48; Gen 41:42-44
- v11 — Dan 4:8-9; Dan 4:18; Dan 2:47-48
- v12 — Dan 5:14; Dan 6:3; Dan 1:7; Prov 12:26; Dan 5:16
- v13 — Dan 6:13; Dan 5:11
- v20 — 2 Kgs 17:14; Ex 9:17; Heb 3:13; Jer 13:18; Prov 16:18
- v23 — Job 12:10; Dan 4:37; Jer 10:23; Isa 2:12; Isa 37:23
- v27 — Job 31:6; 1 Cor 3:13; Ps 62:9
- v28 — Isa 13:17; Dan 6:28; Isa 21:2; Dan 5:31

Chapter 6

Daniel's enemies tricked Darius into signing a decree forbidding prayer to anyone but the king for thirty days. Daniel continued praying three times daily toward Jerusalem and was cast into the den of lions. God shut the lions' mouths, and the next morning Daniel was found unharmed. Darius decreed that all should fear the God of Daniel.

1 *It pleased Darius to set over the kingdom an hundred and twenty princes, which should be over the whole kingdom;* It pleased Darius to appoint 120 satraps to rule throughout the kingdom,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Darius** (duh-RY-us) — Persian/Median name meaning "possessor" — Darius the Mede took Babylon after Belshazzar's death. He appointed Daniel as one of three chief administrators over the entire empire.

- 2 *And over these three presidents; of whom Daniel was first: that the princes might give accounts unto them, and the king should have no damage.* with three administrators over them, of whom Daniel was one. The satraps were accountable to them so that the king would not suffer any loss.
- 3 *Then this Daniel was preferred above the presidents and princes, because an excellent spirit was in him; and the king thought to set him over the whole realm.* Daniel so distinguished himself among the administrators and satraps by his exceptional qualities that the king planned to set him over the whole kingdom.
- 4 *Then the presidents and princes sought to find occasion against Daniel concerning the kingdom; but they could find none occasion nor fault; forasmuch as he was faithful, neither was there any error or fault found in him.* At this, the administrators and satraps tried to find grounds for charges against Daniel in his conduct of government affairs. But they could find no corruption in him, because he was trustworthy and neither corrupt nor negligent.
- 5 *Then said these men, We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, except we find it against him concerning the law of his God.* Finally these men said, "We will never find any basis for charges against this Daniel unless it has to do with the law of his God."
- 6 *Then these presidents and princes assembled together to the king, and said thus unto him, King Darius, live for ever.* So these administrators and satraps went as a group to the king and said: "O King Darius, live forever!
- 7 *All the presidents of the kingdom, the governors, and the princes, the counsellors, and the captains, have consulted together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.* The royal administrators, prefects, satraps, advisers, and governors have all agreed that the king should issue an edict and enforce the decree that anyone who prays to any god or man during the next thirty days, except to you, O king, shall be thrown into the lions' den.

- 8 *Now, O king, establish the decree, and sign the writing, that it be not changed, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not.* Now, O king, issue the decree and put it in writing so that it cannot be altered — in accordance with the law of the Medes and Persians, which cannot be repealed."
- 9 *Wherefore king Darius signed the writing and the decree.* So King Darius put the decree in writing.
- 10 *Now when Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house; and his windows being open in his chamber toward Jerusalem, he kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did aforetime.* When Daniel learned that the decree had been published, he went home to his upstairs room where the windows opened toward Jerusalem. Three times a day he got down on his knees and prayed, giving thanks to his God, just as He had done before.
- 11 *Then these men assembled, and found Daniel praying and making supplication before his God.* Then these men came together and found Daniel praying and asking God for help.
- 12 *Then they came near, and spake before the king concerning the king's decree; Hast thou not signed a decree, that every man that shall ask a petition of any God or man within thirty days, save of thee, O king, shall be cast into the den of lions? The king answered and said, The thing is true, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not.* So they went to the king and spoke to him about his royal decree: "Did you not publish a decree that during the next thirty days anyone who prays to any god or man except to you, O king, would be thrown into the lions' den?" The king answered, "The decree stands — in accordance with the law of the Medes and Persians, which cannot be repealed."
- 13 *Then answered they and said before the king, That Daniel, which is of the children of the captivity of Judah, regardeth not thee, O king, nor the decree that thou hast signed, but maketh his petition three times a day.* Then they said to the king, "Daniel, who is one of the exiles from Judah, pays no attention to you, O king, or to the decree you put in writing. He still prays three times a day."

- 14 *Then the king, when he heard these words, was sore displeased with himself, and set his heart on Daniel to deliver him: and he laboured till the going down of the sun to deliver him.* When the king heard this, he was greatly distressed. He was determined to rescue Daniel and made every effort until sundown to save him.
- 15 *Then these men assembled unto the king, and said unto the king, Know, O king, that the law of the Medes and Persians is, That no decree nor statute which the king establisheth may be changed.* Then the men went as a group to the king and said to him, "Remember, O king, that according to the law of the Medes and Persians no decree or edict that the king issues can be changed."
- 16 *Then the king commanded, and they brought Daniel, and cast him into the den of lions. Now the king spake and said unto Daniel, Thy God whom thou servest continually, he will deliver thee.* So the king gave the order, and they brought Daniel and threw him into the lions' den. The king said to Daniel, "May your God, whom you serve continually, deliver you!"
- 17 *And a stone was brought, and laid upon the mouth of the den; and the king sealed it with his own signet, and with the signet of his lords; that the purpose might not be changed concerning Daniel.* A stone was brought and placed over the mouth of the den, and the king sealed it with his own signet ring and with the rings of his nobles, so that Daniel's situation might not be changed.
- 18 *Then the king went to his palace, and passed the night fasting: neither were instruments of musick brought before him: and his sleep went from him.* Then the king returned to his palace and spent the night without eating. No entertainment was brought to him, and he could not sleep.
- 19 *Then the king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste unto the den of lions.* At the first light of dawn, the king got up and hurried to the lions' den.

- 20 *And when he came to the den, he cried with a lamentable voice unto Daniel: and the king spake and said to Daniel, O Daniel, servant of the living God, is thy God, whom thou servest continually, able to deliver thee from the lions?* When he came near the den, he called to Daniel in an anguished voice, "Daniel, servant of the living God, has your God, whom you serve continually, been able to rescue you from the lions?"
- 21 *Then said Daniel unto the king, O king, live for ever.* Daniel answered, "O king, live forever!
- 22 *My God hath sent his angel, and hath shut the lions' mouths, that they have not hurt me: forasmuch as before him innocency was found in me; and also before thee, O king, have I done no hurt.* My God sent his angel, and He shut the mouths of the lions. They have not hurt me, because I was found innocent in His sight. Nor have I done any wrong before you, O king."
- 23 *Then was the king exceeding glad for him, and commanded that they should take Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no manner of hurt was found upon him, because he believed in his God.* The king was overjoyed and gave orders to lift Daniel out of the den. When Daniel was lifted from the den, no wound was found on him, because he had trusted in his God.
- 24 *And the king commanded, and they brought those men which had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions, them, their children, and their wives; and the lions had the mastery of them, and brake all their bones in pieces or ever they came at the bottom of the den.* At the king's command, the men who had falsely accused Daniel were brought in and thrown into the lions' den, along with their wives and children. Before they reached the floor of the den, the lions overpowered them and crushed all their bones.
- 25 *Then king Darius wrote unto all people, nations, and languages, that dwell in all the earth; Peace be multiplied unto you.* Then King Darius wrote to all the peoples, nations, and men of every language throughout the land: "May you prosper greatly!

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| <p>26 <i>I make a decree, That in every dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel: for he is the living God, and stedfast for ever, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed, and his dominion shall be even unto the end.</i></p> <p>27 <i>He delivereth and rescueth, and he worketh signs and wonders in heaven and in earth, who hath delivered Daniel from the power of the lions.</i></p> <p>28 <i>So this Daniel prospered in the reign of Darius, and in the reign of Cyrus the Persian.</i></p> | <p>I issue a decree that in every part of my kingdom people must fear and reverence the God of Daniel. For he is the living God and He endures forever. His kingdom will not be destroyed; His dominion will never end.</p> <p>He rescues and He saves. He performs signs and wonders in the heavens and on the earth. He has rescued Daniel from the power of the lions."</p> <p>So Daniel prospered during the reign of Darius and the reign of Cyrus the Persian.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cyrus (*SY-rus*) — The Persian king who conquered Babylon and issued the decree allowing the Jews to return home — named in Isaiah's prophecy 150 years before his birth.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v3 — Dan 5:14; Prov 22:29; Gen 41:38-41; Dan 5:12; Esth 10:3
- v4 — 1 Pet 3:16; Phil 2:15; 1 Pet 2:12; Luke 20:20; Luke 23:14-15
- v5 — Acts 24:13-16; Acts 24:20-21; Esth 3:8; 1 Sam 24:17; John 19:6-7
- v10 — Acts 5:29; Ps 55:17; 1 Thess 5:17-18; Ps 95:6; Phil 4:6
- v12 — Dan 6:8; Dan 3:8-12
- v16 — Ps 37:39-40; Job 5:19; Ps 91:14-16; Dan 3:28; Isa 43:2
- v18 — Dan 2:1; Esth 6:1
- v20 — Heb 7:25; Dan 6:27; 1 Chr 16:11; Dan 6:16; 2 Tim 4:16-18
- v22 — 2 Tim 4:17; Heb 11:33; Acts 12:11; Ps 91:11-13; Acts 24:16
- v23 — 1 Chr 5:20; Mark 9:23; Dan 3:25; Dan 3:27-28; Dan 6:18
- v26 — Dan 4:34; Luke 1:33; Dan 4:3; Dan 7:14; Ps 29:10
- v27 — Dan 4:2-3; Acts 4:30; Ps 18:50; Ps 97:10

Chapter 7

Daniel will see a vision of four great beasts rising from the sea — a lion, a bear, a leopard, and a fourth beast dreadful and terrible with ten horns. The Ancient of days will sit in judgment,

and one like the Son of man will come with the clouds of heaven and receive an everlasting kingdom that will never be destroyed.

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| <p>1 <i>In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon Daniel had a dream and visions of his head upon his bed: then he wrote the dream, and told the sum of the matters.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Daniel spake and said, I saw in my vision by night, and, behold, the four winds of the heaven strove upon the great sea.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And four great beasts came up from the sea, diverse one from another.</i></p> <p>4 <i>The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings: I beheld till the wings thereof were plucked, and it was lifted up from the earth, and made stand upon the feet as a man, and a man's heart was given to it.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And behold another beast, a second, like to a bear, and it raised up itself on one side, and it had three ribs in the mouth of it between the teeth of it: and they said thus unto it, Arise, devour much flesh.</i></p> <p>6 <i>After this I beheld, and lo another, like a leopard, which had upon the back of it four wings of a fowl; the beast had also four heads; and dominion was given to it.</i></p> | <p>In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon, Daniel had a dream and visions while lying on his bed. He wrote down the substance of his dream.</p> <p>Daniel said: "In my vision at night I looked, and there before me were the four winds of heaven churning up the great sea.</p> <p>Four great beasts, each different from the others, came up out of the sea.</p> <p>The first was like a lion, and it had the wings of an eagle. I watched until its wings were torn off and it was lifted from the ground so that it stood on two feet like a man, and the mind of a man was given to it.</p> <p>There before me was a second beast, which looked like a bear. It was raised up on one of its sides, and it had three ribs in its mouth between its teeth. It was told, 'Get up and eat your fill of flesh!'</p> <p>After that, I looked, and there before me was another beast, one that looked like a leopard. On its back it had four wings like those of a bird. This beast had four heads, and it was given authority to rule.</p> |
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- 7 *After this I saw in the night visions, and behold a fourth beast, dreadful and terrible, and strong exceedingly; and it had great iron teeth: it devoured and brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with the feet of it: and it was diverse from all the beasts that were before it; and it had ten horns.* After that, in my vision at night I looked, and there before me was a fourth beast — terrifying and frightening and very powerful. It had large iron teeth; it crushed and devoured its victims and trampled underfoot whatever was left. It was different from all the former beasts, and it had ten horns.
- 8 *I considered the horns, and, behold, there came up among them another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots: and, behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man, and a mouth speaking great things.* While I was thinking about the horns, another horn — a little one — came up among them. Three of the first horns were uprooted before it. This horn had eyes like the eyes of a man and a mouth that spoke boastfully.
- 9 *I beheld till the thrones were cast down, and the Ancient of days did sit, whose garment was white as snow, and the hair of his head like the pure wool: his throne was like the fiery flame, and his wheels as burning fire.* As I looked, thrones were set in place, and the Ancient of Days took His seat. His clothing was as white as snow; the hair of His head was white like wool. His throne was flaming with fire, and its wheels were all ablaze.
- 10 *A fiery stream issued and came forth from before him: thousand thousands ministered unto him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him: the judgment was set, and the books were opened.* A river of fire was flowing, coming out from before Him. Thousands upon thousands attended Him; ten thousand times ten thousand stood before Him. The court was seated, and the books were opened.
- 11 *I beheld then because of the voice of the great words which the horn spake: I beheld even till the beast was slain, and his body destroyed, and given to the burning flame.* Then I continued to watch because of the boastful words the horn was speaking. I kept looking until the beast was slain and its body destroyed and thrown into the blazing fire.

- 12 *As concerning the rest of the beasts, they had their dominion taken away: yet their lives were prolonged for a season and time.* The other beasts had been stripped of their authority, but were allowed to live for a period of time.
- 13 *I saw in the night visions, and, behold, one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven, and came to the Ancient of days, and they brought him near before him.* In my vision at night I looked, and there before me was one like the Son of man, coming with the clouds of heaven. He came to the Ancient of Days, and they brought Him near before Him.
- 14 *And there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed.* He was given authority, glory, and sovereign power. All peoples, nations, and men of every language worshiped Him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion that will not pass away, and His kingdom is one that will never be destroyed.
- 15 *I Daniel was grieved in my spirit in the midst of my body, and the visions of my head troubled me.* I, Daniel, was troubled in my spirit, and the visions that passed through my mind disturbed me.
- 16 *I came near unto one of them that stood by, and asked him the truth of all this. So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things.* I approached one of those standing there and asked him the true meaning of all this. He told me and gave me the interpretation of these things:
- 17 *These great beasts, which are four, are four kings, which shall arise out of the earth.* The four great beasts are four kingdoms that will rise from the earth.
- 18 *But the saints of the most High shall take the kingdom, and possess the kingdom for ever, even for ever and ever.* But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom and will possess it forever — yes, forever and ever.

- 19 *Then I would know the truth of the fourth beast, which was diverse from all the others, exceeding dreadful, whose teeth were of iron, and his nails of brass; which devoured, brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with his feet;* Then I wanted to know the true meaning of the fourth beast, which was different from all the others and most terrifying, with its iron teeth and bronze claws — the beast that crushed and devoured its victims and trampled underfoot whatever was left.
- 20 *And of the ten horns that were in his head, and of the other which came up, and before whom three fell; even of that horn that had eyes, and a mouth that spake very great things, whose look was more stout than his fellows.* I also wanted to know about the ten horns on its head and about the other horn that came up, before which three of them fell — the horn that looked more imposing than the others and that had eyes and a mouth that spoke boastfully.
- 21 *I beheld, and the same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them;* As I watched, this horn was waging war against the saints and defeating them,
- 22 *Until the Ancient of days came, and judgment was given to the saints of the most High; and the time came that the saints possessed the kingdom.* until the Ancient of Days came and pronounced judgment in favor of the saints of the Most High, and the time came when they possessed the kingdom.
- 23 *Thus he said, The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms, and shall devour the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces.* He gave me this explanation: 'The fourth beast is a fourth kingdom that will appear on earth. It will be different from all the other kingdoms and will devour the whole earth, trampling it down and crushing it.
- 24 *And the ten horns out of this kingdom are ten kings that shall arise: and another shall rise after them; and he shall be diverse from the first, and he shall subdue three kings.* The ten horns are ten kings who will come from this kingdom. After them another king will arise, different from the earlier ones; He will subdue three kings.

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| <p>25 <i>And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time.</i></p> <p>26 <i>But the judgment shall sit, and they shall take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it unto the end.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And the kingdom and dominion, and the greatness of the kingdom under the whole heaven, shall be given to the people of the saints of the most High, whose kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey him.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Hitherto is the end of the matter. As for me Daniel, my cogitations much troubled me, and my countenance changed in me: but I kept the matter in my heart.</i></p> | <p>He will speak against the Most High and oppress His saints and try to change the set times and the laws. The saints will be handed over to Him for a time, times, and half a time.</p> <p>But the court will sit, and His power will be taken away and completely destroyed forever.</p> <p>Then the sovereignty, power, and greatness of the kingdoms under the whole heaven will be handed over to the saints, the people of the Most High. His kingdom will be an everlasting kingdom, and all rulers will worship and obey Him.'</p> <p>This is the end of the matter. I, Daniel, was greatly troubled by my thoughts, and my countenance changed in me. But I kept the matter in my heart."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Cross-References:

- v7 — Rev 13:1; Rev 12:3; Rev 17:12; Dan 7:23-24; Dan 7:19-20
v8 — Rev 13:5-6; Rev 13:1
v9 — Rev 1:14; Mark 9:3; Dan 7:13; Matt 17:2; Dan 7:22
v10 — Isa 30:27; Rev 20:11-15; Deut 33:2; Rev 5:11; Ps 50:3
v11 — Rev 19:20; Rev 20:10; Dan 7:8; 2 Thess 2:8
v13 — Matt 26:64; Rev 1:7; Luke 21:27; Rev 14:14; Matt 24:30
v14 — Rev 11:15; Dan 7:27; Dan 2:44; John 3:35; 1 Cor 15:24-28
v18 — Dan 7:27; Rev 5:10; Isa 60:12-14; Rev 20:4; Rev 2:26-27

v21 — Dan 12:7; Dan 8:24; Rev 13:5-18; Rev 17:14

v23 — Dan 2:40; Dan 7:7

v25 — Dan 12:7; Rev 12:14; 2 Thess 2:4; Rev 13:5-11; Rev 12:6

v27 — Ps 72:11; Rev 11:15; Luke 1:33; Dan 7:14; Ps 22:27

Chapter 8

Daniel will see a vision of a ram with two horns — Media and Persia — conquered by a he-goat with a great horn — Greece. The great horn will be broken and four kingdoms will arise in its place. A king of fierce countenance will arise in the latter time, destroying many and standing against the Prince of princes, but he will be broken without hand.

- 1 *In the third year of the reign of king Belshazzar a vision appeared unto me, even unto me Daniel, after that which appeared unto me at the first.* In the third year of King Belshazzar's reign, I, Daniel, had a vision, after the one that had already appeared to me.
- 2 *And I saw in a vision; and it came to pass, when I saw, that I was at Shushan in the palace, which is in the province of Elam; and I saw in a vision, and I was by the river of Ulai.* In my vision I saw myself in the citadel of Susa in the province of Elam. In the vision I was beside the Ulai Canal.
- 3 *Then I lifted up mine eyes, and saw, and, behold, there stood before the river a ram which had two horns: and the two horns were high; but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last.* I looked up, and there before me was a ram with two horns, standing beside the canal. The two horns were long, but one was longer than the other, and the longer one grew up later.
- 4 *I saw the ram pushing westward, and northward, and southward; so that no beasts might stand before him, neither was there any that could deliver out of his hand; but he did according to his will, and became great.* I watched the ram as it charged toward the west, north, and south. No animal could stand against it, and none could rescue from its power. It did as it pleased and became great.
- 5 *And as I was considering, behold, an he goat came from the west on the face of the whole earth, and touched not the ground: and the goat had a notable horn between his eyes.* As I was thinking about this, suddenly a goat with a prominent horn between its eyes came from the west, crossing the whole earth without touching the ground.

- 6 *And he came to the ram that had two horns, which I had seen standing before the river, and ran unto him in the fury of his power.* It came toward the two-horned ram I had seen standing beside the canal and charged at it in great rage.
- 7 *And I saw him come close unto the ram, and he was moved with choler against him, and smote the ram, and brake his two horns: and there was no power in the ram to stand before him, but he cast him down to the ground, and stamped upon him: and there was none that could deliver the ram out of his hand.* I watched it attack the ram furiously, striking the ram and shattering its two horns. The ram was powerless to stand against it. The goat knocked it to the ground and trampled on it, and no one could rescue the ram from its power.
- 8 *Therefore the he goat waxed very great: and when he was strong, the great horn was broken; and for it came up four notable ones toward the four winds of heaven.* The goat became very great, but at the height of its power its large horn was broken off, and in its place four prominent horns grew up toward the four winds of heaven.
- 9 *And out of one of them came forth a little horn, which waxed exceeding great, toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the pleasant land.* Out of one of them came another horn, which started small but grew greatly toward the south and east and toward the Beautiful Land.
- 10 *And it waxed great, even to the host of heaven; and it cast down some of the host and of the stars to the ground, and stamped upon them.* It grew until it reached the host of the heavens, and it threw some of the starry host down to the earth and trampled on them.
- 11 *Yea, he magnified himself even to the prince of the host, and by him the daily sacrifice was taken away, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down.* It set itself up to be as great as the Prince of the host; it took away the daily sacrifice from Him, and the place of His sanctuary was brought low.

- 12 *And an host was given him against the daily sacrifice by reason of transgression, and it cast down the truth to the ground; and it practised, and prospered.* Because of transgression, the host of the saints and the daily sacrifice were given over to it. It prospered in everything it did and truth was thrown to the ground.
- 13 *Then I heard one saint speaking, and another saint said unto that certain saint which spake, How long shall be the vision concerning the daily sacrifice, and the transgression of desolation, to give both the sanctuary and the host to be trodden under foot?* Then I heard a holy one speaking, and another holy one said to him, "How long will it take for the vision to be fulfilled — the vision concerning the daily sacrifice, the rebellion that causes desolation, and the surrender of the sanctuary and of the host that will be trampled underfoot?"
- 14 *And he said unto me, Unto two thousand and three hundred days; then shall the sanctuary be cleansed.* He said to me, "It will take 2,300 evenings and mornings; then the sanctuary will be reconsecrated."
- 15 *And it came to pass, when I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, and sought for the meaning, then, behold, there stood before me as the appearance of a man.* While I, Daniel, was watching the vision and trying to understand it, there before me stood one who looked like a man.
- 16 *And I heard a man's voice between the banks of Ulai, which called, and said, Gabriel, make this man to understand the vision.* And I heard a man's voice from the Ulai calling, "Gabriel, tell this man the meaning of the vision."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gabriel** (GAY-bree-el) — "God is my strength" — One of the named archangels in Scripture. He appears to Daniel to explain visions, and later to Zechariah and Mary in the New Testament.

- 17 *So he came near where I stood: and when he came, I was afraid, and fell upon my face: but he said unto me, Understand, O son of man: for at the time of the end shall be the vision.* As he came near the place where I was standing, I was terrified and fell face down. He said to me, "Understand, son of man, that the vision concerns the time of the end."

- 18 *Now as he was speaking with me, I was in a deep sleep on my face toward the ground: but he touched me, and set me upright.* While he was speaking to me, I was in a deep sleep with my face to the ground. Then he touched me and raised me to my feet.
- 19 *And he said, Behold, I will make thee know what shall be in the last end of the indignation: for at the time appointed the end shall be.* He said: "I am going to tell you what will happen later in the time of wrath, because the vision concerns the appointed time of the end.
- 20 *The ram which thou sawest having two horns are the kings of Media and Persia.* The two-horned ram that you saw represents the kings of Media and Persia.
- 21 *And the rough goat is the king of Grecia: and the great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.* The shaggy goat is the king of Greece, and the large horn between its eyes is the first king.
- 22 *Now that being broken, whereas four stood up for it, four kingdoms shall stand up out of the nation, but not in his power.* The four horns that replaced the one that was broken off represent four kingdoms that will emerge from his nation but will not have the same power.
- 23 *And in the latter time of their kingdom, when the transgressors are come to the full, a king of fierce countenance, and understanding dark sentences, shall stand up.* In the latter part of their reign, when rebels have become completely wicked, a king of fierce countenance and understanding dark sentences will arise.
- 24 *And his power shall be mighty, but not by his own power: and he shall destroy wonderfully, and shall prosper, and practise, and shall destroy the mighty and the holy people.* He will become very strong, but not by his own power. He will cause astounding devastation and will succeed in whatever he does. He will destroy the mighty men and the holy people.

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| <p>25 <i>And through his policy also he shall cause craft to prosper in his hand; and he shall magnify himself in his heart, and by peace shall destroy many: he shall also stand up against the Prince of princes; but he shall be broken without hand.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And the vision of the evening and the morning which was told is true: wherefore shut thou up the vision; for it shall be for many days.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And I Daniel fainted, and was sick certain days; afterward I rose up, and did the king's business; and I was astonished at the vision, but none understood it.</i></p> | <p>He will cause deceit to prosper, and he will consider himself superior. When they feel secure, he will destroy many and take his stand against the Prince of princes. Yet he will be destroyed, but not by human power.</p> <p>The vision of the evenings and mornings that has been given you is true, but seal up the vision, for it concerns the distant future."</p> <p>I, Daniel, was worn out. I lay exhausted for several days. Then I got up and went about the king's business. I was appalled by the vision; it was beyond understanding.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Persia (*PER-zhah*) — The empire that conquered Babylon in 539 BC — Cyrus, Darius, and Xerxes (Ahasuerus) were Persian kings; they allowed the Jews to return from exile.

Cross-References:

v2 — Neh 1:1; Esth 1:2

v5 — Dan 8:21

v9 — Dan 11:16

v10 — Isa 14:13; Rev 12:4

v11 — Dan 12:11; Rev 13:5-7

v13 — Rev 11:2; Luke 21:24; Dan 9:27; Rev 6:10

v14 — Dan 12:7; Rev 11:2-3; Dan 7:25; Dan 12:11; Isa 45:25

v16 — Luke 1:26; Luke 1:19

v17 — Dan 8:19; Dan 12:4

v23 — 2 Thess 2:9-11; Rev 13:11-14; Rev 19:20; Dan 8:9-12; 1 Tim 4:1

v25 — Dan 8:11; Rev 17:14; Dan 11:32-33

v26 — Dan 10:1; Dan 12:9; Dan 10:14; Dan 12:4; Rev 22:10

Chapter 9

Daniel prayed and confessed the sins of his people, pleading for God's mercy on Jerusalem. The angel Gabriel appeared and revealed the prophecy of seventy weeks determined upon Israel — to finish transgression, make an end of sins, and bring in everlasting righteousness. Messiah the Prince will come and be cut off, and the city and sanctuary will be destroyed.

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| 1 <i>In the first year of Darius the son of Ahasuerus, of the seed of the Medes, which was made king over the realm of the Chaldeans;</i> | In the first year of Darius son of Ahasuerus — a Mede by descent, who was made ruler over the Babylonian kingdom — |
| 2 <i>In the first year of his reign I Daniel understood by books the number of the years, whereof the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah the prophet, that he would accomplish seventy years in the desolations of Jerusalem.</i> | in the first year of His reign, I, Daniel, understood from the Scriptures, according to the word of the LORD given to Jeremiah the prophet, that the desolation of Jerusalem would last seventy years. |
| 3 <i>And I set my face unto the Lord God, to seek by prayer and supplications, with fasting, and sackcloth, and ashes:</i> | So I turned to the Lord God and pleaded with Him in prayer and petition, in fasting, and in sackcloth and ashes. |
| 4 <i>And I prayed unto the LORD my God, and made my confession, and said, O Lord, the great and dreadful God, keeping the covenant and mercy to them that love him, and to them that keep his commandments;</i> | I prayed to the LORD my God and confessed: "O Lord, the great and awesome God, Who keeps His covenant and mercy with all who love Him and keep His commandments — |
| 5 <i>We have sinned, and have committed iniquity, and have done wickedly, and have rebelled, even by departing from thy precepts and from thy judgments:</i> | we have sinned and done wrong. We have been wicked and have rebelled; we have turned away from Your commands and laws. |
| 6 <i>Neither have we hearkened unto thy servants the prophets, which spake in thy name to our kings, our princes, and our fathers, and to all the people of the land.</i> | We have not listened to Your servants the prophets, who spoke in Your name to our kings, our princes, and our fathers, and to all the people of the land. |

- 7 *O LORD, righteousness belongeth unto thee, but unto us confusion of faces, as at this day; to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and unto all Israel, that are near, and that are far off, through all the countries whither thou hast driven them, because of their trespass that they have trespassed against thee.* O LORD, righteousness belongs to You, but to us confusion of face, as it is this day — the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem and all Israel, both near and far, in all the countries where You have scattered us because of the trespass they have trespassed against You.
- 8 *O Lord, to us belongeth confusion of face, to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers, because we have sinned against thee.* O LORD, we and our kings, our princes, and our fathers are covered with shame because we have sinned against You.
- 9 *To the Lord our God belong mercies and forgivenesses, though we have rebelled against him;* The Lord our God is merciful and forgiving, even though we have rebelled against Him.
- 10 *Neither have we obeyed the voice of the LORD our God, to walk in his laws, which he set before us by his servants the prophets.* We have not obeyed the LORD our God or kept the laws He gave us through His servants the prophets.
- 11 *Yea, all Israel have transgressed thy law, even by departing, that they might not obey thy voice; therefore the curse is poured upon us, and the oath that is written in the law of Moses the servant of God, because we have sinned against him.* All Israel has transgressed Your law and turned away, refusing to obey You. Therefore the curses and sworn judgments written in the Law of Moses the servant of God have been poured out on us, because we have sinned against You.
- 12 *And he hath confirmed his words, which he spake against us, and against our judges that judged us, by bringing upon us a great evil: for under the whole heaven hath not been done as hath been done upon Jerusalem.* You have fulfilled the words spoken against us and against our rulers by bringing on us great disaster. Under the whole heaven nothing has ever been done like what has been done to Jerusalem.

- 13 *As it is written in the law of Moses, all this evil is come upon us: yet made we not our prayer before the LORD our God, that we might turn from our iniquities, and understand thy truth.* Just as it is written in the Law of Moses, all this disaster has come on us; yet we have not sought the favor of the LORD our God by turning from our iniquities and giving attention to Your truth.
- 14 *Therefore hath the LORD watched upon the evil, and brought it upon us: for the LORD our God is righteous in all his works which he doeth: for we obeyed not his voice.* The LORD did not hesitate to bring disaster on us, for the LORD our God is righteous in everything He does; yet we have not obeyed Him.
- 15 *And now, O Lord our God, that hast brought thy people forth out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, and hast gotten thee renown, as at this day; we have sinned, we have done wickedly.* Now, O Lord our God, Who brought Your people out of Egypt with a mighty hand and who made for Yourself a name that endures to this day — we have sinned; we have done wickedly.
- 16 *O LORD, according to all thy righteousness, I beseech thee, let thine anger and thy fury be turned away from thy city Jerusalem, thy holy mountain: because for our sins, and for the iniquities of our fathers, Jerusalem and thy people are become a reproach to all that are about us.* O Lord, in keeping with all Your righteous acts, turn away Your anger and wrath from Jerusalem, Your city, Your holy hill. Our sins and the iniquities of our fathers have made Jerusalem and Your people an object of scorn to all those around us.
- 17 *Now therefore, O our God, hear the prayer of thy servant, and his supplications, and cause thy face to shine upon thy sanctuary that is desolate, for the Lord's sake.* Now, our God, hear the prayers and petitions of Your servant. For Your sake, O Lord, look with favor on Your desolate sanctuary.

- 18 *O my God, incline thine ear, and hear; open thine eyes, and behold our desolations, and the city which is called by thy name: for we do not present our supplications before thee for our righteousnesses, but for thy great mercies.* Give ear, O my God, and hear. Open Your eyes and see the desolation of the city that bears Your Name. We do not make requests of You because we are righteous, but because of Your great mercy.
- 19 *O Lord, hear; O Lord, forgive; O Lord, hearken and do; defer not, for thine own sake, O my God: for thy city and thy people are called by thy name.* O Lord, listen! O Lord, forgive! O Lord, hear and act! For Your sake, O my God, do not delay, because Your city and Your people bear Your Name."
- 20 *And whiles I was speaking, and praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before the LORD my God for the holy mountain of my God;* While I was speaking and praying, confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel and making my request to the LORD my God for His holy hill —
- 21 *Yea, whiles I was speaking in prayer, even the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening oblation.* while I was still in prayer, Gabriel, the man I had seen in the earlier vision, came to me in swift flight about the time of the evening sacrifice.
- 22 *And he informed me, and talked with me, and said, O Daniel, I am now come forth to give thee skill and understanding.* He instructed me and said to me, "Daniel, I have now come to give you insight and understanding.
- 23 *At the beginning of thy supplications the commandment came forth, and I am come to shew thee; for thou art greatly beloved: therefore understand the matter, and consider the vision.* As soon as you began to pray, an answer was given, which I have come to tell you, for you are greatly beloved. Therefore consider the message and understand the vision:

- 24 *Seventy weeks are determined upon thy people and upon thy holy city, to finish the transgression, and to make an end of sins, and to make reconciliation for iniquity, and to bring in everlasting righteousness, and to seal up the vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most Holy.*
- 25 *Know therefore and understand, that from the going forth of the commandment to restore and to build Jerusalem unto the Messiah the Prince shall be seven weeks, and threescore and two weeks: the street shall be built again, and the wall, even in troublous times.*
- 26 *And after threescore and two weeks shall Messiah be cut off, but not for himself: and the people of the prince that shall come shall destroy the city and the sanctuary; and the end thereof shall be with a flood, and unto the end of the war desolations are determined.*
- 27 *And he shall confirm the covenant with many for one week: and in the midst of the week he shall cause the sacrifice and the oblation to cease, and for the overspreading of abominations he shall make it desolate, even until the consummation, and that determined shall be poured upon the desolate.*
- Seventy weeks are determined upon your people and upon your holy city, to finish the transgression, and to make an end of sins, and to make reconciliation for iniquity, and to bring in everlasting righteousness, and to seal up the vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most Holy.
- Know and understand this: From the issuing of the decree to restore and rebuild Jerusalem until Messiah the Prince, there will be seven weeks and sixty-two weeks. The street shall be built again, and the wall, even in troublous times.
- After the sixty-two weeks, Messiah shall be cut off, but not for Himself. The people of the prince who is to come shall destroy the city and the sanctuary. The end will come like a flood. War will continue until the end, and desolations have been decreed.
- He will confirm a covenant with many for one week. In the middle of that week he will put an end to sacrifice and offering. For the overspreading of abominations he shall make it desolate, even until the consummation, and that determined shall be poured upon the desolate."

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 29:10; Jer 25:11-12; 2 Chr 36:21; Zech 7:5; Rev 1:3
- v3 — Jer 29:10-13; Jer 33:3; Jas 5:16-18; Neh 1:4-11; Esth 4:16
- v4 — Rom 8:28; Ex 20:6; Deut 5:10; Ex 34:6-7; Dan 9:5-12
- v5 — Mal 3:7; Dan 9:11; Dan 9:15; Ps 106:6
- v9 — Eph 1:6-8; Dan 9:7; Ps 86:15; Dan 9:5; Ps 130:7
- v13 — Deut 28:15-68; Isa 9:13; Hos 7:10; Dan 9:11; Lev 26:14-46
- v20 — Ps 145:18; Dan 9:3-4; Rom 3:23
- v23 — Dan 10:19; Dan 10:11-12; Matt 24:15; Luke 1:28; Song 7:10
- v24 — Heb 9:11-14; Rom 5:10; Jer 23:5-6; Num 14:34; Isa 61:1
- v25 — Ezra 4:24; John 4:25; John 1:41; Isa 55:4; Isa 9:6
- v26 — Isa 53:8; Nah 1:8; Luke 24:26; Mark 13:2
- v27 — Matt 24:15; Dan 12:11; Mark 13:14; Luke 21:20; Dan 11:36

Chapter 10

After three weeks of mourning and fasting, Daniel saw a vision of a glorious man clothed in linen by the river Tigris. The angel told Daniel he was greatly beloved and explained that the prince of Persia had withstood him twenty-one days until Michael came to help. He came to reveal what will happen to Daniel's people in the latter days.

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| <p>¹ <i>In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia a thing was revealed unto Daniel, whose name was called Belteshazzar; and the thing was true, but the time appointed was long: and he understood the thing, and had understanding of the vision.</i></p> | <p>In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia, a revelation was given to Daniel — whose name was also Belteshazzar. The message was true, but the time appointed was long. He understood the message and had understanding of the vision.</p> |
| <p>² <i>In those days I Daniel was mourning three full weeks.</i></p> | <p>At that time I, Daniel, mourned for three full weeks.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>I ate no pleasant bread, neither came flesh nor wine in my mouth, neither did I anoint myself at all, till three whole weeks were fulfilled.</i></p> | <p>I ate no choice food. No meat or wine touched my lips, and I used no lotions at all until the three weeks were over.</p> |

- 4 *And in the four and twentieth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel;* On the twenty-fourth day of the first month, as I was standing on the bank of the great river, the Hiddekel —
- 5 *Then I lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a certain man clothed in linen, whose loins were girded with fine gold of Uphaz:* I looked up and there before me was a man dressed in linen, with a belt of fine gold from Uphaz around his waist.
- 6 *His body also was like the beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as lamps of fire, and his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass, and the voice of his words like the voice of a multitude.* His body was like topaz, his face like lightning, his eyes like flaming torches, his arms and legs like the gleam of burnished bronze, and his voice like the sound of a crowd.
- 7 *And I Daniel alone saw the vision: for the men that were with me saw not the vision; but a great quaking fell upon them, so that they fled to hide themselves.* I, Daniel, was the only one who saw the vision. The men with me did not see it, but such terror overwhelmed them that they fled and hid themselves.
- 8 *Therefore I was left alone, and saw this great vision, and there remained no strength in me: for my comeliness was turned in me into corruption, and I retained no strength.* So I was left alone, gazing at this great vision. I had no strength left; my face turned deathly pale and I was helpless.
- 9 *Yet heard I the voice of his words: and when I heard the voice of his words, then was I in a deep sleep on my face, and my face toward the ground.* Then I heard him speaking, and as I listened to him, I fell into a deep sleep, face down to the ground.
- 10 *And, behold, an hand touched me, which set me upon my knees and upon the palms of my hands.* A hand touched me and set me trembling on my hands and knees.

- 11 *And he said unto me, O Daniel, a man greatly beloved, understand the words that I speak unto thee, and stand upright: for unto thee am I now sent. And when he had spoken this word unto me, I stood trembling.* He said, "Daniel, you who are greatly beloved, consider carefully the words I am about to speak to you, and stand up, for I have now been sent to you." When he said this to me, I stood up trembling.
- 12 *Then said he unto me, Fear not, Daniel: for from the first day that thou didst set thine heart to understand, and to chasten thyself before thy God, thy words were heard, and I am come for thy words.* Then he continued, "Do not fear, Daniel. Since the first day that you set your mind to gain understanding and to humble yourself before your God, Your words were heard, and I have come in response to them.
- 13 *But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me one and twenty days: but, lo, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me; and I remained there with the kings of Persia.* But the prince of the Persian kingdom resisted me twenty-one days. Then Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me, because I was detained there with the king of Persia.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Michael** (MY-kul) — "Who is like God?" — One of the chief archangels. He is described as the great prince who stands guard over Israel. He appears in Daniel, Jude, and Revelation.
- 14 *Now I am come to make thee understand what shall befall thy people in the latter days: for yet the vision is for many days.* Now I have come to explain to you what will happen to your people in the future, for the vision concerns a time yet to come."
- 15 *And when he had spoken such words unto me, I set my face toward the ground, and I became dumb.* While he was saying this to me, I bowed with my face toward the ground and was speechless.
- 16 *And, behold, one like the similitude of the sons of men touched my lips: then I opened my mouth, and spake, and said unto him that stood before me, O my lord, by the vision my sorrows are turned upon me, and I have retained no strength.* Then one like the similitude of the sons of men touched my lips, and I opened my mouth and spoke. I said to the one standing before me, "O my lord, by the vision my sorrows are turned upon me, and I have retained no strength.

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| <p>17 <i>For how can the servant of this my lord talk with this my lord? for as for me, straightway there remained no strength in me, neither is there breath left in me.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Then there came again and touched me one like the appearance of a man, and he strengthened me,</i></p> <p>19 <i>And said, O man greatly beloved, fear not: peace be unto thee, be strong, yea, be strong. And when he had spoken unto me, I was strengthened, and said, Let my lord speak; for thou hast strengthened me.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Then said he, Knowest thou wherefore I come unto thee? and now will I return to fight with the prince of Persia: and when I am gone forth, lo, the prince of Grecia shall come.</i></p> <p>21 <i>But I will shew thee that which is noted in the scripture of truth: and there is none that holdeth with me in these things, but Michael your prince.</i></p> | <p>How can I, your servant, talk with you, my lord? My strength is gone and I can hardly breathe."</p> <p>Again the one who looked like a man touched me and gave me strength.</p> <p>"Do not be afraid, O man greatly beloved," he said. "Peace! Be strong now; be strong." When he spoke to me, I was strengthened and said, "Speak, my lord, since you have given me strength."</p> <p>So he said, "Do you know why I have come to you? Soon I will return to fight against the prince of Persia, and when I go, the prince of Greece will come.</p> <p>But first I will tell you what is written in the Book of Truth. No one supports me against them except Michael, your prince.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Dan 1:21; Dan 6:28; Dan 8:26; Dan 1:7
v5 — Rev 1:13-15; Ezek 9:2; Dan 12:6-7; Jer 10:9; Rev 15:6-7
v6 — Rev 19:12; Rev 1:13-17; Matt 17:2; Rev 10:3-4
v7 — Acts 9:7; Acts 22:9; Gen 3:10
v8 — Dan 7:28; Hab 3:16; Dan 8:27
v10 — Rev 1:17; Jer 1:9; Dan 8:18
v12 — Acts 10:30-31; Dan 10:19; Isa 58:9; Dan 9:20-23; Acts 18:9-10
v13 — Jude 1:9; Dan 12:1; Dan 10:20-21; Rev 12:7; Ezra 4:4-6

v14 — Dan 8:26; Dan 2:28; Hab 2:3; Dan 12:4; Dan 12:9

v16 — Dan 8:15; Isa 6:7; Jer 1:9

v19 — Isa 35:4; Josh 1:9; Judg 6:23; Dan 9:23; Dan 10:11-12

v21 — Dan 10:13; Rev 12:7; Dan 12:1; Jude 1:9

Chapter 11

The angel reveals a detailed prophecy of wars between the kings of the north and south — from Persia through Greece and the kingdoms that follow. A vile person will rise, set up the abomination of desolation, and exalt himself above every god. He will prosper until the indignation is accomplished, then come to his end with none to help him.

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| 1 | <i>Also I in the first year of Darius the Mede, even I, stood to confirm and to strengthen him.</i> | And in the first year of Darius the Mede, I stood up to confirm and strengthen him. |
| 2 | <i>And now will I shew thee the truth. Behold, there shall stand up yet three kings in Persia; and the fourth shall be far richer than they all: and by his strength through his riches he shall stir up all against the realm of Grecia.</i> | Now then, I will tell you the truth. Three more kings will appear in Persia, and then a fourth, who will be far richer than all the others. When he has gained power by his wealth, he will stir up everyone against the kingdom of Greece. |
| 3 | <i>And a mighty king shall stand up, that shall rule with great dominion, and do according to his will.</i> | Then a mighty king will appear, who will rule with great power and do as he pleases. |
| 4 | <i>And when he shall stand up, his kingdom shall be broken, and shall be divided toward the four winds of heaven; and not to his posterity, nor according to his dominion which he ruled: for his kingdom shall be plucked up, even for others beside those.</i> | After he has appeared, his empire will be broken up and parceled out toward the four winds of heaven. It will not go to his descendants, nor will it have the power he exercised, because his empire will be uprooted and given to others. |
| 5 | <i>And the king of the south shall be strong, and one of his princes; and he shall be strong above him, and have dominion; his dominion shall be a great dominion.</i> | The king of the South will become strong, but one of his commanders will become even stronger than he and will rule his own kingdom with great power. |

- 6 *And in the end of years they shall join themselves together; for the king's daughter of the south shall come to the king of the north to make an agreement: but she shall not retain the power of the arm; neither shall he stand, nor his arm: but she shall be given up, and they that brought her, and he that begat her, and he that strengthened her in these times.* After some years, they will become allies. The daughter of the king of the South will go to the king of the North to make an alliance, but she will not retain her power, and he and his power will not last. In those days she will be betrayed, together with her royal escort and her father and the one who supported her.
- 7 *But out of a branch of her roots shall one stand up in his estate, which shall come with an army, and shall enter into the fortress of the king of the north, and shall deal against them, and shall prevail:* One from her family line will arise to take her place. He will attack the forces of the king of the North and enter his fortress; he will fight against them and be victorious.
- 8 *And shall also carry captives into Egypt their gods, with their princes, and with their precious vessels of silver and of gold; and he shall continue more years than the king of the north.* He will also seize their gods, their metal images, and their valuable articles of silver and gold and carry them off to Egypt. For some years he will leave the king of the North alone.
- 9 *So the king of the south shall come into his kingdom, and shall return into his own land.* Then the king of the North will invade the realm of the king of the South but will retreat to his own country.
- 10 *But his sons shall be stirred up, and shall assemble a multitude of great forces: and one shall certainly come, and overflow, and pass through: then shall he return, and be stirred up, even to his fortress.* His sons will prepare for war and assemble a great army, which will sweep on like an irresistible flood and carry the battle as far as his fortress.

- 11 *And the king of the south shall be moved with choler, and shall come forth and fight with him, even with the king of the north: and he shall set forth a great multitude; but the multitude shall be given into his hand.* Then the king of the South will march out in a rage and fight against the king of the North, who will raise a large army, but it will be defeated.
- 12 *And when he hath taken away the multitude, his heart shall be lifted up; and he shall cast down many ten thousands: but he shall not be strengthened by it.* When the army is carried off, the king of the South will be filled with pride and will slaughter many thousands, yet he will not remain triumphant.
- 13 *For the king of the north shall return, and shall set forth a multitude greater than the former, and shall certainly come after certain years with a great army and with much riches.* For the king of the North will muster another army, larger than the first; and after several years, he will advance with a huge army fully equipped.
- 14 *And in those times there shall many stand up against the king of the south: also the robbers of thy people shall exalt themselves to establish the vision; but they shall fall.* In those times many will rise against the king of the South. The violent men among your own people will rebel in fulfillment of the vision, but without success.
- 15 *So the king of the north shall come, and cast up a mount, and take the most fenced cities: and the arms of the south shall not withstand, neither his chosen people, neither shall there be any strength to withstand.* Then the king of the North will come and build up siege works and capture a fortified city. The forces of the South will be powerless to resist; even their elite troops will not have the strength to stand.
- 16 *But he that cometh against him shall do according to his own will, and none shall stand before him: and he shall stand in the glorious land, which by his hand shall be consumed.* The invader will do as he pleases; no one will be able to stand against him. He will establish himself in the Beautiful Land and will have the power to destroy it.

- 17 *He shall also set his face to enter with the strength of his whole kingdom, and upright ones with him; thus shall he do: and he shall give him the daughter of women, corrupting her: but she shall not stand on his side, neither be for him.* He will determine to come with the full power of his kingdom and will make an alliance with the king of the South. He will give him a daughter in marriage in order to overthrow the kingdom, but his plans will not succeed or help him.
- 18 *After this shall he turn his face unto the isles, and shall take many: but a prince for his own behalf shall cause the reproach offered by him to cease; without his own reproach he shall cause it to turn upon him.* Then he will turn his attention to the coastlands and will take many of them, but a commander will put an end to his insolence and will turn his insolence back on him.
- 19 *Then he shall turn his face toward the fort of his own land: but he shall stumble and fall, and not be found.* After this, he will turn back toward the fortresses of his own country but will stumble and fall, to be seen no more.
- 20 *Then shall stand up in his estate a raiser of taxes in the glory of the kingdom: but within few days he shall be destroyed, neither in anger, nor in battle.* His successor will send out a tax collector to maintain the royal splendor. In a few years, however, he will be destroyed, yet not in anger or in battle.
- 21 *And in his estate shall stand up a vile person, to whom they shall not give the honour of the kingdom: but he shall come in peaceably, and obtain the kingdom by flatteries.* He will be succeeded by a contemptible person who has not been given the honor of royalty. He will invade the kingdom when its people feel secure, and he will seize it through intrigue.
- 22 *And with the arms of a flood shall they be overflown from before him, and shall be broken; yea, also the prince of the covenant.* Then an overwhelming army will be swept away before him; both it and a prince of the covenant will be destroyed.
- 23 *And after the league made with him he shall work deceitfully: for he shall come up, and shall become strong with a small people.* After coming to an agreement with him, he will act deceitfully, and with only a few people he will rise to power.

- 24 *He shall enter peaceably even upon the fattest places of the province; and he shall do that which his fathers have not done, nor his fathers' fathers; he shall scatter among them the prey, and spoil, and riches: yea, and he shall forecast his devices against the strong holds, even for a time.* When the richest provinces feel secure, he will invade them and will achieve what neither his fathers nor his forefathers did. He will distribute plunder, loot, and wealth among his followers. He will plot the overthrow of fortresses — but only for a time.
- 25 *And he shall stir up his power and his courage against the king of the south with a great army; and the king of the south shall be stirred up to battle with a very great and mighty army; but he shall not stand: for they shall forecast devices against him.* With a large army he will stir up his strength and courage against the king of the South. The king of the South will wage war with a large and very powerful army, but he will not be able to stand because of the plots devised against him.
- 26 *Yea, they that feed of the portion of his meat shall destroy him, and his army shall overflow: and many shall fall down slain.* Those who eat from the king's provisions will try to destroy him; his army will be swept away, and many will fall in battle.
- 27 *And both these kings' hearts shall be to do mischief, and they shall speak lies at one table; but it shall not prosper: for yet the end shall be at the time appointed.* The two kings, with their hearts bent on evil, will sit at the same table and lie to each other, but to no avail, because an end will still come at the appointed time.
- 28 *Then shall he return into his land with great riches; and his heart shall be against the holy covenant; and he shall do exploits, and return to his own land.* The king of the North will return to his own country with great wealth, but his heart will be set against the holy covenant. He will take action against it and then return to his own country.
- 29 *At the time appointed he shall return, and come toward the south; but it shall not be as the former, or as the latter.* At the appointed time he will invade the South again, but this time the outcome will be different from what it was before.

- 30 *For the ships of Chittim shall come against him: therefore he shall be grieved, and return, and have indignation against the holy covenant: so shall he do; he shall even return, and have intelligence with them that forsake the holy covenant.* Ships of the western coastlands will oppose him, and he will lose heart. Then he will turn back and vent his fury against the holy covenant. He will return and show favor to those who forsake the holy covenant.
- 31 *And arms shall stand on his part, and they shall pollute the sanctuary of strength, and shall take away the daily sacrifice, and they shall place the abomination that maketh desolate.* His armed forces will rise up to desecrate the temple fortress and will abolish the daily sacrifice. Then they will set up the abomination that causes desolation.
- 32 *And such as do wickedly against the covenant shall he corrupt by flatteries: but the people that do know their God shall be strong, and do exploits.* With flattery he will corrupt those who have violated the covenant, but the people who know their God will firmly resist Him.
- 33 *And they that understand among the people shall instruct many: yet they shall fall by the sword, and by flame, by captivity, and by spoil, many days.* Those who are wise will instruct many, though for a time they will fall by the sword or be burned or captured or plundered.
- 34 *Now when they shall fall, they shall be holpen with a little help: but many shall cleave to them with flatteries.* When they fall, they will receive a little help, and many who are not sincere will join them.
- 35 *And some of them of understanding shall fall, to try them, and to purge, and to make them white, even to the time of the end: because it is yet for a time appointed.* Some of the wise will stumble, so that they may be refined, purified, and made spotless until the time of the end, for it will still come at the appointed time.

- 36 *And the king shall do according to his will; and he shall exalt himself, and magnify himself above every god, and shall speak marvellous things against the God of gods, and shall prosper till the indignation be accomplished: for that that is determined shall be done.* The king will do as he pleases. He will exalt and magnify himself above every god and will say unheard-of things against the God of gods. He will be successful until the time of wrath is completed, for what has been determined must take place.
- 37 *Neither shall he regard the God of his fathers, nor the desire of women, nor regard any god: for he shall magnify himself above all.* He will show no regard for the gods of his fathers or for the one desired by women, nor will he regard any god, but will exalt himself above them all.
- 38 *But in his estate shall he honour the God of forces: and a god whom his fathers knew not shall he honour with gold, and silver, and with precious stones, and pleasant things.* Instead of them, he will honor a god of fortresses; a god unknown to His fathers. He will honor with gold and silver, with precious stones and costly gifts.
- 39 *Thus shall he do in the most strong holds with a strange god, whom he shall acknowledge and increase with glory: and he shall cause them to rule over many, and shall divide the land for gain.* He will attack the mightiest fortresses with the help of a foreign god and will greatly honor those who acknowledge Him. He will make them rulers over many people and will distribute the land at a price.
- 40 *And at the time of the end shall the king of the south push at him: and the king of the north shall come against him like a whirlwind, with chariots, and with horsemen, and with many ships; and he shall enter into the countries, and shall overflow and pass over.* At the time of the end the king of the South will engage him in battle, and the king of the North will storm out against him with chariots and cavalry and a great fleet of ships. He will invade many countries and sweep through them like a flood.

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| <p>41 <i>He shall enter also into the glorious land, and many countries shall be overthrown: but these shall escape out of his hand, even Edom, and Moab, and the chief of the children of Ammon.</i></p> <p>42 <i>He shall stretch forth his hand also upon the countries: and the land of Egypt shall not escape.</i></p> <p>43 <i>But he shall have power over the treasures of gold and of silver, and over all the precious things of Egypt: and the Libyans and the Ethiopians shall be at his steps.</i></p> <p>44 <i>But tidings out of the east and out of the north shall trouble him: therefore he shall go forth with great fury to destroy, and utterly to make away many.</i></p> <p>45 <i>And he shall plant the tabernacles of his palace between the seas in the glorious holy mountain; yet he shall come to his end, and none shall help him.</i></p> | <p>He will also invade the Beautiful Land. Many countries will fall, but Edom, Moab, and the leaders of Ammon will be delivered from his hand.</p> <p>He will extend his power over many countries; Egypt will not escape.</p> <p>He will gain control of the treasures of gold and silver and all the riches of Egypt, with the Libyans and Cushites in submission.</p> <p>But reports from the east and the north will alarm him, and he will set out in a great rage to destroy and annihilate many.</p> <p>He will pitch his royal tents between the seas at the beautiful holy mountain. Yet he will come to his end, and no one will help him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ammon (*AM-on*) — The territory east of the Jordan — Ammonites descended from Lot's son Ben-ammi; frequently at war with Israel.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Moab (*MO-ab*) — The territory east of the Dead Sea — Moabites descended from Lot's son Moab; Ruth was a Moabite; Israel passed through Moab before entering Canaan.

Cross-References:

v1 — Dan 9:1

v3 — Dan 11:16; Dan 11:36; Dan 8:21

- v4 — Dan 8:22; Dan 8:8; Jer 12:17
 v19 — Ezek 26:21; Ps 37:36
 v27 — Ps 12:2
 v30 — Gen 10:4; Num 24:24
 v31 — Dan 12:11; Dan 9:27; Matt 24:15; Dan 8:11-13; Mark 13:14
 v32 — 1 Chr 28:9; Ps 9:10; Zech 10:12; John 17:3; Mic 5:7-9
 v35 — Zech 13:9; Mal 3:2-4; Rev 7:14; Prov 17:3; Rev 2:10
 v36 — Rev 13:5-6; 2 Thess 2:4; Isa 14:13; Dan 11:16; Dan 8:19
 v37 — Isa 14:13; 2 Thess 2:4; 1 Tim 4:3
 v41 — Jer 48:47; Jer 49:6

Chapter 12

Michael the great prince will stand up, and there will be a time of trouble such as never was. Many who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake — some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt. Daniel is told to seal the book until the time of the end, and he will rest and stand in his lot at the end of the days.

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| <p>1 <i>And at that time shall Michael stand up, the great prince which standeth for the children of thy people: and there shall be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time: and at that time thy people shall be delivered, every one that shall be found written in the book.</i></p> | <p>At that time Michael, the great prince who protects your people, will arise. There will be a time of distress such as has not happened from the beginning of nations until then. But at that time your people — everyone whose name is found written in the book — will be delivered.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.</i></p> | <p>Many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake — some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they that be wise shall shine as the brightness of the firmament; and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever.</i></p> | <p>Those who are wise will shine like the brightness of the firmament, and those who turn many to righteousness like the stars for ever and ever.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But thou, O Daniel, shut up the words, and seal the book, even to the time of the end: many shall run to and fro, and knowledge shall be increased.</i></p> | <p>But you, Daniel, close up and seal the words of the scroll until the time of the end. Many will go here and there to increase knowledge."</p> |

- 5 *Then I Daniel looked, and, behold, there stood other two, the one on this side of the bank of the river, and the other on that side of the bank of the river.* Then I, Daniel, looked, and there before me stood two others, one on this bank of the river and one on the opposite bank.
- 6 *And one said to the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, How long shall it be to the end of these wonders?* One of them said to the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, "How long will it be before these astonishing things are fulfilled?"
- 7 *And I heard the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand unto heaven, and swore by him that liveth for ever that it shall be for a time, times, and an half; and when he shall have accomplished to scatter the power of the holy people, all these things shall be finished.* The man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, lifted his right hand and his left hand toward heaven, and I heard him swear by Him who lives forever, saying, "It will be for a time, times, and half a time. When the power of the holy people has been finally broken, all these things will be completed."
- 8 *And I heard, but I understood not: then said I, O my lord, what shall be the end of these things?* I heard, but I did not understand. So I asked, "My lord, what will the outcome of all this be?"
- 9 *And he said, Go thy way, Daniel: for the words are closed up and sealed till the time of the end.* He replied, "Go your way, Daniel, because the words are closed up and sealed until the time of the end.
- 10 *Many shall be purified, and made white, and tried; but the wicked shall do wickedly: and none of the wicked shall understand; but the wise shall understand.* Many will be purified, made spotless, and refined, but the wicked will continue to be wicked. None of the wicked will understand, but those who are wise will understand.
- 11 *And from the time that the daily sacrifice shall be taken away, and the abomination that maketh desolate set up, there shall be a thousand two hundred and ninety days.* From the time that the daily sacrifice is abolished and the abomination that causes desolation is set up, there will be 1,290 days.

- 12 *Blessed is he that waiteth, and cometh to the thousand three hundred and five and thirty days.* Blessed is the one who waits for and reaches the end of the 1,335 days.
- 13 *But go thou thy way till the end be: for thou shalt rest, and stand in thy lot at the end of the days.* As for you, go your way till the end. You will rest, and then at the end of the days you will rise to receive your allotted inheritance."
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Words in this chapter:

firmament — The expanse of sky — what God spread out above the earth on Day Two of creation to separate the waters.

Lot (LOT) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Cross-References:

v1 — Matt 24:21; Jer 30:7; Mark 13:19; Rev 16:17-21; Luke 21:23-24

v2 — John 5:28-29; Isa 26:19; Matt 25:46; Ezek 37:12; 1 Cor 15:51-54

v3 — Matt 13:43; Prov 4:18; Jas 5:19-20; Dan 11:33; Dan 11:35

v4 — Dan 12:9; Rev 22:10; Dan 8:26; Dan 8:17; Rev 10:4

v6 — Zech 1:12-13; Ezek 9:2; Dan 8:13

v7 — Dan 7:25; Rev 12:14; Dan 8:24; Rev 10:5-7; Rev 13:5

v9 — Dan 12:4; Dan 8:26

v10 — Rev 22:11; Dan 11:35; Hos 14:9; John 8:47; 2 Thess 2:10-12

v11 — Dan 11:31; Matt 24:15; Mark 13:14; Dan 9:27; Rev 11:2

v12 — Isa 30:18; Dan 8:14; Rom 11:15; Rev 20:4

v13 — Rev 14:13; 2 Tim 4:7-8; 2 Cor 5:1; Zech 3:7

Hosea

Author: Hosea son of Beeri — the book names him (Hos 1:1) and is written in a distinctive personal voice throughout; he is the only writing prophet from the northern kingdom.

Date written: c. 755–715 BC, spanning the reigns of four kings of Judah and the final years of the northern kingdom before Assyria destroyed it in 722 BC.

Written to: The northern kingdom of Israel (also called Ephraim in the book), though the warnings speak to the whole nation.

Setting: Israel is prosperous outwardly under Jeroboam II but spiritually corrupt — Baal worship has intermingled with the worship of the LORD. Hosea is commanded to marry a woman who proves unfaithful, and his marriage becomes a living parable of God's relationship with Israel.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 755–715 BC under Jeroboam II of Israel and the Judean kings Uzziah through Hezekiah, in the very years that the Assyrian empire under Tiglath-Pileser III and Shalmaneser V conquered Samaria in 722 BC.

Contemporaries: Amos was preaching in the north alongside Hosea, while Isaiah and Micah prophesied in the southern kingdom under the same threat from Assyria.

Big themes:

- Spiritual adultery — Israel's idolatry is repeatedly depicted as harlotry; the covenant is a marriage, and Baal worship is betrayal
- God's relentless love — despite Israel's unfaithfulness, God refuses to give them up entirely (11:8); His love persists through discipline
- Judgment as discipline, not abandonment — the Assyrian exile is the consequence of covenant breaking, but it is not the end of the story
- Return and restoration — the book ends with an invitation to return to the LORD and promises of restoration beyond the judgment
- Knowledge of God — "My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge" (4:6); knowing God — not just knowing about Him — is the heart of covenant faithfulness

Key passages: Hos 1:2; 4:6; 6:6; 11:8–9; 14:4

How it fits: Hosea prophesied while Amos, Isaiah, and Micah were also active. His book is the first of the twelve Minor Prophets in canonical order. Matthew quotes Hosea 11:1 as fulfilled in the flight to Egypt (Matt 2:15); Paul quotes Hosea 1:10 and 2:23 to describe Gentile inclusion (Rom 9:25–26).

Chapter 1

The LORD commands Hosea to marry a wife of whoredoms as a picture of Israel's unfaithfulness. Gomer bears three children: Jezreel, Lo-ruhamah ("no mercy"), and Lo-ammi ("not My people"). Yet the LORD promises that in the very place where Israel was rejected, they will be called sons of the living God.

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| <p>1 <i>The word of the LORD that came unto Hosea, the son of Beeri, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel.</i></p> | <p>The word of the LORD that came to Hosea son of Beeri, during the reigns of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam son of Joash, king of Israel.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hosea** (ho-ZAY-uh) — "salvation" — A prophet of Israel in the 8th century BC. God called him to marry an unfaithful woman as a living picture of Israel's unfaithfulness to the LORD.

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| <p>2 <i>The beginning of the word of the LORD by Hosea. And the LORD said to Hosea, Go, take unto thee a wife of whoredoms and children of whoredoms: for the land hath committed great whoredom, departing from the LORD.</i></p> | <p>This was the beginning of the LORD's message through Hosea. The LORD said to Him, "Go, take a wife of whoredoms and have children of whoredoms, for the land has committed great whoredom in departing from the LORD."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>So he went and took Gomer the daughter of Diblaim; which conceived, and bare him a son.</i></p> | <p>So He went and married Gomer daughter of Diblaim, and she conceived and bore Him a son.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gomer** (GO-mer) — a woman of unfaithfulness — Wife of Hosea. Her repeated unfaithfulness pictures Israel's spiritual adultery against God. Hosea's buying her back pictures God's redeeming love for His wayward people.

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| <p>4 <i>And the LORD said unto him, Call his name Jezreel; for yet a little while, and I will avenge the blood of Jezreel upon the house of Jehu, and will cause to cease the kingdom of the house of Israel.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to Him, "Name Him Jezreel, because I will soon punish the house of Jehu for the massacre at Jezreel, and I will put an end to the kingdom of Israel.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And it shall come to pass at that day, that I will break the bow of Israel in the valley of Jezreel.</i></p> | <p>In that day I will break Israel's bow in the Valley of Jezreel."</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And she conceived again, and bare a daughter. And God said unto him, Call her name Lo-ruhamah: for I will no more have mercy upon the house of Israel; but I will utterly take them away.</i></p> <p>7 <i>But I will have mercy upon the house of Judah, and will save them by the LORD their God, and will not save them by bow, nor by sword, nor by battle, by horses, nor by horsemen.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Now when she had weaned Lo-ruhamah, she conceived, and bare a son.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Then said God, Call his name Lo-ammi: for ye are not my people, and I will not be your God.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Yet the number of the children of Israel shall be as the sand of the sea, which cannot be measured nor numbered; and it shall come to pass, that in the place where it was said unto them, Ye are not my people, there it shall be said unto them, Ye are the sons of the living God.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Then shall the children of Judah and the children of Israel be gathered together, and appoint themselves one head, and they shall come up out of the land: for great shall be the day of Jezreel.</i></p> | <p>Gomer conceived again and gave birth to a daughter. The LORD said to Hosea, "Name her Lo-ruhamah — for I will no longer show mercy to Israel or forgive them.</p> <p>But I will show mercy to Judah, and I will save them — not by bow or sword or battle, not by horses or horsemen, but by the LORD their God."</p> <p>After Gomer had weaned Lo-ruhamah, she conceived again and gave birth to a son.</p> <p>The LORD said, "Name Him Lo-ammi — for You are not My people, and I am not Your God."</p> <p>Yet the number of the Israelites will be like the sand of the sea, which cannot be measured or counted. In the very place where it was said to them, "You are not My people," they will be called "sons of the living God."</p> <p>The people of Judah and the people of Israel will come together and appoint one leader. They will come up out of the land, for great will be the day of Jezreel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Hezekiah (*hez-eh-KY-ah*) — One of Judah's best kings who trusted God during the Assyrian siege — he prayed and God destroyed 185,000 Assyrian soldiers overnight; his name means 'the LORD strengthens.'

Hosea (*ho-ZAY-ah*) — A prophet whose marriage to an unfaithful wife illustrated Israel's unfaithfulness to God — his name means 'salvation.'

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rom 9:25; Mic 1:1; Isa 1:1; Amos 1:1
v2 — Hos 3:1; Hos 2:4-5; Deut 31:16; Ps 106:39
v4 — 2 Kgs 10:7-8; 2 Kgs 10:10-11
v6 — 1 Pet 2:10
v7 — Zech 4:6; Isa 12:2; 2 Kgs 19:35; Ps 44:3-6; Hos 11:12
v9 — Jer 15:1
v10 — 2 Cor 6:18; Gal 4:6-7; John 1:12; Rom 9:25-28; 1 Pet 2:9-10
v11 — Hos 3:5; Isa 11:12-13; Jer 50:4-5

Chapter 2

The LORD charges unfaithful Israel like a husband charges his adulterous wife. She chased after her lovers and did not know that the LORD gave her the grain, wine, and oil. He will hedge up her way with thorns until she says, "I will go back to my first husband." Then the LORD will allure her, speak tenderly to her, and betroth her to Himself forever.

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| 1 | <i>Say ye unto your brethren, Ammi; and to your sisters, Ruhamah.</i> | Say to Your brothers, "My people," and to Your sisters, "My beloved." |
| 2 | <i>Plead with your mother, plead: for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband: let her therefore put away her whoredoms out of her sight, and her adulteries from between her breasts;</i> | Plead with Your mother — plead with her! For she is not My wife, and I am not her husband. Let her put away her whoredoms and her adulteries from between her breasts, |
| 3 | <i>Lest I strip her naked, and set her as in the day that she was born, and make her as a wilderness, and set her like a dry land, and slay her with thirst.</i> | or I will strip her naked and expose her as on the day she was born. I will make her like a desert, turn her into a parched land, and let her die of thirst. |

- 4 *And I will not have mercy upon her children; for they be the children of whoredoms.* I will not show mercy to her children, because they are the children of whoredoms.
- 5 *For their mother hath played the harlot: she that conceived them hath done shamefully: for she said, I will go after my lovers, that give me my bread and my water, my wool and my flax, mine oil and my drink.* Their mother has played the harlot and done shamefully. She said, "I will go after my lovers, who give me my bread and water, my wool and my flax, my oil and my drink."
- 6 *Therefore, behold, I will hedge up thy way with thorns, and make a wall, that she shall not find her paths.* Therefore I will block her path with thornbushes. I will wall her in so that she cannot find her way.
- 7 *And she shall follow after her lovers, but she shall not overtake them; and she shall seek them, but shall not find them: then shall she say, I will go and return to my first husband; for then was it better with me than now.* She will chase after her lovers but not catch them. She will look for them but not find them. Then she will say, "I will go back to my first husband, for I was better off then than now."
- 8 *For she did not know that I gave her corn, and wine, and oil, and multiplied her silver and gold, which they prepared for Baal.* She did not know that I was the one giving her the grain, the new wine, and the olive oil — and that I lavished silver and gold on her, which they used for Baal.
- 9 *Therefore will I return, and take away my corn in the time thereof, and my wine in the season thereof, and will recover my wool and my flax given to cover her nakedness.* Therefore I will take back My grain when it ripens and My new wine when it is ready. I will take away My wool and My linen, which I gave her to cover her nakedness.
- 10 *And now will I discover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and none shall deliver her out of mine hand.* So I will expose her shame before the eyes of her lovers, and no one will take her out of My hands.
- 11 *I will also cause all her mirth to cease, her feast days, her new moons, and her sabbaths, and all her solemn feasts.* I will stop all her celebrations — her yearly festivals, her New Moons, her Sabbath days, all her appointed feasts.

- 12 *And I will destroy her vines and her fig trees, whereof she hath said, These are my rewards that my lovers have given me: and I will make them a forest, and the beasts of the field shall eat them.* I will ruin her vines and her fig trees, which she said were payment from her lovers. I will turn them into a thicket, and wild animals will devour them.
- 13 *And I will visit upon her the days of Baalim, wherein she burned incense to them, and she decked herself with her earrings and her jewels, and she went after her lovers, and forgot me, saith the LORD.* I will punish her for the days she burned incense to the Baals, when she adorned herself with rings and jewelry and went after her lovers — and forgot Me, declares the LORD.
- 14 *Therefore, behold, I will allure her, and bring her into the wilderness, and speak comfortably unto her.* Therefore I am now going to draw her away and lead her into the desert, and speak tenderly to her.
- 15 *And I will give her her vineyards from thence, and the valley of Achor for a door of hope: and she shall sing there, as in the days of her youth, and as in the day when she came up out of the land of Egypt.* There I will give her back her vineyards and will make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. She will sing there as in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.
- 16 *And it shall be at that day, saith the LORD, that thou shalt call me Ishi; and shalt call me no more Baali.* "In that day," declares the LORD, "you will call Me 'my husband.' You will no longer call Me 'my master.'"
- 17 *For I will take away the names of Baalim out of her mouth, and they shall no more be remembered by their name.* I will remove the names of the Baals from her lips; no longer will their names be invoked.
- 18 *And in that day will I make a covenant for them with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven, and with the creeping things of the ground: and I will break the bow and the sword and the battle out of the earth, and will make them to lie down safely.* In that day I will make a covenant for them with the beasts of the field, the birds in the sky, and the creatures that move along the ground. I will abolish the bow and sword and battle from the land, so that all may rest in safety.

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| <p>19 <i>And I will betroth thee unto me for ever; yea, I will betroth thee unto me in righteousness, and in judgment, and in lovingkindness, and in mercies.</i></p> <p>20 <i>I will even betroth thee unto me in faithfulness: and thou shalt know the LORD.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, I will hear, saith the LORD, I will hear the heavens, and they shall hear the earth;</i></p> <p>22 <i>And the earth shall hear the corn, and the wine, and the oil; and they shall hear Jezreel.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And I will sow her unto me in the earth; and I will have mercy upon her that had not obtained mercy; and I will say to them which were not my people, Thou art my people; and they shall say, Thou art my God.</i></p> | <p>I will betroth You to Me forever. I will betroth You in righteousness and justice, in love and mercy.</p> <p>I will betroth You in faithfulness, and You will know the LORD.</p> <p>In that day I will respond," declares the LORD — "I will respond to the skies, and they will respond to the earth;</p> <p>the earth will respond to the grain, the new wine, and the olive oil, and they will respond to Jezreel.</p> <p>I will plant her for Myself in the land. I will show mercy to the one I called 'Not My people.' I will say to those called 'Not My people,' 'You are My people,' and they will say, 'You are my God.' "</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v2** — Isa 50:1; Ezek 23:45; Jer 3:13; Ezek 16:25
v6 — Job 19:8; Lam 3:7-9; Job 3:23
v11 — Isa 1:13-14; Amos 5:21; Amos 8:5; Jer 7:34; Jer 16:9
v13 — Judg 3:7; Hos 13:6; Hos 11:2; Hos 13:1
v14 — Isa 40:1-2; Ezek 20:35-36; Isa 30:18; Rev 12:6
v15 — Ezek 28:26; Jer 2:2; Hos 11:1; Josh 7:26; Ezek 16:8
v16 — Isa 54:5; Hos 2:7
v17 — Ex 23:13; Josh 23:7; Ps 16:4; Zech 13:2
v18 — Ezek 34:25; Ezek 39:9-10; Isa 11:6-9; Ps 46:9; Isa 2:4

v19 — 2 Cor 11:2; Rev 21:2; Isa 54:14; Isa 54:8-10; Rev 19:7-9

v20 — John 17:3; 1 John 4:6; 1 John 5:20; Jer 24:7; Col 1:10

v23 — Rom 9:25-26; 1 Pet 2:9-10; Zech 13:9; Hos 1:9-10; Rom 3:29

Chapter 3

The LORD commands Hosea to love his adulterous wife again and buy her back — a picture of how the LORD loves Israel despite her unfaithfulness. She is to remain faithful for many days, for Israel will abide many days without a king, without a prince, and without a sacrifice. Afterward they will return and seek the LORD their God and David their king.

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| <p>1 <i>Then said the LORD unto me, Go yet, love a woman beloved of her friend, yet an adulteress, according to the love of the LORD toward the children of Israel, who look to other gods, and love flagons of wine.</i></p> | <p>The LORD said to me, "Go, show Your love to Your wife again, though she is loved by another man and is an adulteress. Love her as the LORD loves the Israelites, though they turn to other gods and love the sacred raisin cakes."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>So I bought her to me for fifteen pieces of silver, and for an homer of barley, and an half homer of barley:</i></p> | <p>So I bought her for fifteen pieces of silver and about a homer and a half of barley.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And I said unto her, Thou shalt abide for me many days; thou shalt not play the harlot, and thou shalt not be for another man: so will I also be for thee.</i></p> | <p>Then I told her, "You are to live with me many days; You must not play the harlot or be with any other man, and I will also be for You."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For the children of Israel shall abide many days without a king, and without a prince, and without a sacrifice, and without an image, and without an ephod, and without teraphim:</i></p> | <p>For the Israelites will live many days without king or prince, without sacrifice or sacred stone, without ephod or household gods.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Afterward shall the children of Israel return, and seek the LORD their God, and David their king; and shall fear the LORD and his goodness in the latter days.</i></p> | <p>Afterward the Israelites will return and seek the LORD their God and David their king. They will come trembling to the LORD and to His goodness in the last days.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

ephod (*EE-fod*) — The high priest's sacred outer garment — a linen apron-like vestment with two onyx stones bearing the tribal names and holding the breastplate.

teraphim (*TEHR-ah-fim*) — Household idols used for divination — Rachel stole her father Laban's teraphim; Micah in Judges had teraphim; they represent false worship.

Cross-References:

v1 — Jer 3:12-14; Mic 7:18-20; Hos 1:2-3; Isa 45:22; Jer 31:20

v3 — Deut 21:13

v4 — Judg 17:5

v5 — Jer 50:4-5; Jer 30:9; Ezek 34:23-24; Isa 2:2; Ezek 37:22-25

Chapter 4

The LORD brings a charge against Israel: there is no truth, no mercy, no knowledge of God in the land. "My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge." The priests feed on the people's sin, and the spirit of whoredoms has led them astray — they sacrifice on the mountaintops and burn incense under every green tree.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear the word of the LORD, ye children of Israel: for the LORD hath a controversy with the inhabitants of the land, because there is no truth, nor mercy, nor knowledge of God in the land.</i></p> | <p>Hear the word of the LORD, You Israelites! The LORD has a charge to bring against You who live in the land: there is no faithfulness, no mercy, no knowledge of God in the land.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>By swearing, and lying, and killing, and stealing, and committing adultery, they break out, and blood toucheth blood.</i></p> | <p>There is cursing, lying, murder, stealing, and adultery. Violence breaks out, and bloodshed follows bloodshed.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Therefore shall the land mourn, and every one that dwelleth therein shall languish, with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven; yea, the fishes of the sea also shall be taken away.</i></p> | <p>Because of this the land dries up, and all who live in it waste away. The beasts of the field, the birds in the sky, and the fish in the sea are swept away.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Yet let no man strive, nor reprove another: for thy people are as they that strive with the priest.</i></p> | <p>But let no one bring a charge; let no one accuse another. Your people are like those who bring charges against a priest.</p> |

- 5 *Therefore shalt thou fall in the day, and the prophet also shall fall with thee in the night, and I will destroy thy mother.* You stumble day and night, and the prophets stumble with You. So I will destroy Your mother —
- 6 *My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge: because thou hast rejected knowledge, I will also reject thee, that thou shalt be no priest to me: seeing thou hast forgotten the law of thy God, I will also forget thy children.* my people are destroyed from lack of knowledge. Because You have rejected knowledge, I also reject You as My priests. Because You have ignored the law of Your God, I also will ignore Your children.
- 7 *As they were increased, so they sinned against me: therefore will I change their glory into shame.* The more priests there were, the more they sinned against Me; they exchanged their glory for something shameful.
- 8 *They eat up the sin of my people, and they set their heart on their iniquity.* They feed on the sins of My people and relish their iniquity.
- 9 *And there shall be, like people, like priest: and I will punish them for their ways, and reward them their doings.* And it will be: like people, like priests. I will punish both of them for their ways and repay them for their deeds.
- 10 *For they shall eat, and not have enough: they shall commit whoredom, and shall not increase: because they have left off to take heed to the LORD.* They will eat but not have enough; they will commit whoredom but not increase, because they have left off to take heed to the LORD to give themselves
- 11 *Whoredom and wine and new wine take away the heart.* to whoredom. Old wine and new wine take away the heart of My people.
- 12 *My people ask counsel at their stocks, and their staff declareth unto them: for the spirit of whoredoms hath caused them to err, and they have gone a whoring from under their God.* They consult a wooden idol and are answered by a stick of wood. A spirit of whoredoms has caused them to err; they have gone a whoring from under their God.

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| <p>13 <i>They sacrifice upon the tops of the mountains, and burn incense upon the hills, under oaks and poplars and elms, because the shadow thereof is good: therefore your daughters shall commit whoredom, and your spouses shall commit adultery.</i></p> <p>14 <i>I will not punish your daughters when they commit whoredom, nor your spouses when they commit adultery: for themselves are separated with whores, and they sacrifice with harlots: therefore the people that doth not understand shall fall.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Though thou, Israel, play the harlot, yet let not Judah offend; and come not ye unto Gilgal, neither go ye up to Beth-aven, nor swear, The LORD liveth.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For Israel slideth back as a backsliding heifer: now the LORD will feed them as a lamb in a large place.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Ephraim is joined to idols: let him alone.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Their drink is sour: they have committed whoredom continually: her rulers with shame do love, Give ye.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The wind hath bound her up in her wings, and they shall be ashamed because of their sacrifices.</i></p> | <p>They sacrifice on the mountaintops and burn incense on the hills, under oaks and poplars and elms, because the shade is good. Therefore Your daughters shall commit whoredom, and Your spouses shall commit adultery.</p> <p>I will not punish Your daughters when they commit whoredom, nor Your spouses when they commit adultery, because the men themselves are separated with whores and sacrifice with harlots. A people without understanding will come to ruin!</p> <p>Even if You, Israel, commit adultery, do not let Judah become guilty. Do not go to Gilgal; do not go up to Beth Aven. Do not swear, "As the LORD lives!"</p> <p>Israel has slid back like a backsliding heifer. Now the LORD will feed them like a lamb in a large place.</p> <p>Ephraim is joined to idols — leave Him alone!</p> <p>Even when their drinks are gone, they keep on committing adultery. Their rulers dearly love shameful ways.</p> <p>A whirlwind will sweep them away, and their sacrifices will bring them shame.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

whoredom — Sexual immorality — also used in the prophets to describe Israel's spiritual unfaithfulness to God, treating it as adultery against the covenant.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 4:22; Mic 6:2
- v3 — Zeph 1:3; Isa 24:4-12; Nah 1:4; Amos 5:16; Ezek 38:20
- v5 — Jer 15:8; Hos 2:2
- v6 — Isa 5:13; Prov 19:2; Hos 6:6; 2 Cor 4:3-6; Hos 4:1
- v7 — Hos 13:6; Phil 3:19; 1 Sam 2:30
- v8 — Isa 56:11; Titus 1:11; Mic 3:11
- v10 — Mic 6:14; Lev 26:26; Hag 1:6
- v11 — Prov 20:1; Luke 21:34; Isa 28:7
- v12 — Jer 2:27; Hos 5:4
- v13 — Isa 1:29; Jer 3:6
- v15 — Hos 9:15; Hos 12:11
- v17 — Ps 81:12

Chapter 5

Judgment falls on the priests, the people, and the royal house — all have gone deep into corruption. Ephraim and Judah will stumble in their iniquity. The LORD will tear them like a lion and go away until they acknowledge their guilt and seek His face in their affliction.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear ye this, O priests; and hearken, O house of Israel; and give ye ear, O house of the king; for judgment is toward you, because ye have been a snare on Mizpah, and a net spread upon Tabor.</i></p> | <p>Hear this, You priests! Pay attention, you Israelites! Listen, you of the royal house! This judgment is against you: you have been a snare at Mizpah, a net spread out on Tabor.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And the revolters are profound to make slaughter, though I have been a rebuker of them all.</i></p> | <p>The rebels are knee-deep in slaughter. I will discipline all of them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>I know Ephraim, and Israel is not hid from me: for now, O Ephraim, thou committest whoredom, and Israel is defiled.</i></p> | <p>I know Ephraim, and Israel is not hidden from Me. Ephraim, You now commit whoredom; Israel is defiled.</p> |

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| 4 <i>They will not frame their doings to turn unto their God: for the spirit of whoredoms is in the midst of them, and they have not known the LORD.</i> | Their deeds do not permit them to return to their God. The spirit of whoredoms is in their midst; they do not know the LORD. |
| 5 <i>And the pride of Israel doth testify to his face: therefore shall Israel and Ephraim fall in their iniquity; Judah also shall fall with them.</i> | Israel's arrogance testifies against them. Israel and Ephraim stumble in their iniquity; Judah also stumbles with them. |
| 6 <i>They shall go with their flocks and with their herds to seek the LORD; but they shall not find him; he hath withdrawn himself from them.</i> | When they go with their flocks and herds to seek the LORD, they will not find Him; He has withdrawn from them. |
| 7 <i>They have dealt treacherously against the LORD: for they have begotten strange children: now shall a month devour them with their portions.</i> | They are unfaithful to the LORD; they give birth to illegitimate children. Now their feasts will devour them and their fields. |
| 8 <i>Blow ye the cornet in Gibeah, and the trumpet in Ramah: cry aloud at Beth-aven, after thee, O Benjamin.</i> | Sound the trumpet in Gibeah, the horn in Ramah. Raise the battle cry in Beth Aven; lead on, Benjamin! |
| 9 <i>Ephraim shall be desolate in the day of rebuke: among the tribes of Israel have I made known that which shall surely be.</i> | Ephraim will be laid waste on the day of reckoning. Among the tribes of Israel I proclaim what is certain. |
| 10 <i>The princes of Judah were like them that remove the bound: therefore I will pour out my wrath upon them like water.</i> | Judah's leaders are like those who move boundary stones. I will pour out My wrath on them like a flood of water. |
| 11 <i>Ephraim is oppressed and broken in judgment, because he willingly walked after the commandment.</i> | Ephraim is oppressed, trampled in judgment, intent on pursuing idols. |
| 12 <i>Therefore will I be unto Ephraim as a moth, and to the house of Judah as rottenness.</i> | I am like a moth to Ephraim, like rot to the people of Judah. |

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| <p>13 <i>When Ephraim saw his sickness, and Judah saw his wound, then went Ephraim to the Assyrian, and sent to king Jareb: yet could he not heal you, nor cure you of your wound.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For I will be unto Ephraim as a lion, and as a young lion to the house of Judah: I, even I, will tear and go away; I will take away, and none shall rescue him.</i></p> <p>15 <i>I will go and return to my place, till they acknowledge their offence, and seek my face: in their affliction they will seek me early.</i></p> | <p>When Ephraim saw His sickness, and Judah saw His sores, then Ephraim turned to Assyria, and sent to the great king for help. But He is not able to cure You, not able to heal Your sores.</p> <p>For I will be like a lion to Ephraim, like a great lion to Judah. I will tear them to pieces and go away; I will carry them off, with no one to rescue them.</p> <p>Then I will return to My place until they admit their guilt. And they will seek My face; in their misery they will earnestly seek Me.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hos 9:8
- v2 — Isa 29:15; Hos 9:15
- v4 — Hos 4:12; 1 John 2:3-4
- v5 — Hos 7:10
- v6 — John 7:34; Prov 1:28; Mic 6:6-7
- v7 — Hos 6:7
- v8 — Joel 2:1; Hos 9:9; Hos 4:15
- v10 — Deut 19:14
- v11 — Mic 6:16
- v13 — Hos 7:11; Jer 30:12; Hos 10:6; Hos 12:1
- v14 — Ps 7:2; Mic 5:8; Hos 13:7-8; Ps 50:22
- v15 — Isa 26:16; Jer 29:12-14; Deut 4:29-31; Ps 78:34; Ps 50:15

Chapter 6

Israel calls out to return to the LORD who has torn them but will heal them. Yet the LORD responds: "Your goodness is like a morning cloud, and like the early dew it goes away." He

desires mercy and not sacrifice, and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings. Ephraim and Judah have transgressed the covenant.

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| 1 | <i>Come, and let us return unto the LORD: for he hath torn, and he will heal us; he hath smitten, and he will bind us up.</i> | "Come, let us return to the LORD. He has torn us to pieces but He will heal us; He has injured us but He will bind up our wounds. |
| 2 | <i>After two days will he revive us: in the third day he will raise us up, and we shall live in his sight.</i> | After two days He will revive us; on the third day He will restore us, that we may live in His presence. |
| 3 | <i>Then shall we know, if we follow on to know the LORD: his going forth is prepared as the morning; and he shall come unto us as the rain, as the latter and former rain unto the earth.</i> | Let us acknowledge the LORD; let us press on to know Him. As surely as the sun rises, He will appear; He will come to us like the winter rains, like the spring rains that water the earth." |
| 4 | <i>O Ephraim, what shall I do unto thee? O Judah, what shall I do unto thee? for your goodness is as a morning cloud, and as the early dew it goeth away.</i> | What can I do with You, Ephraim? What can I do with You, Judah? Your love is like the morning mist, like the early dew that disappears. |
| 5 | <i>Therefore have I hewed them by the prophets; I have slain them by the words of my mouth: and thy judgments are as the light that goeth forth.</i> | Therefore I cut You in pieces with My prophets; I killed You with the words of My mouth — then My judgments go forth like the sun. |
| 6 | <i>For I desired mercy, and not sacrifice; and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings.</i> | For I desire mercy, and not sacrifice, and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings. |
| 7 | <i>But they like men have transgressed the covenant: there have they dealt treacherously against me.</i> | As at Adam, they have transgressed the covenant; they were unfaithful to Me there. |
| 8 | <i>Gilead is a city of them that work iniquity, and is polluted with blood.</i> | Gilead is a city of evildoers, stained with footprints of blood. |

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| 9 | <i>And as troops of robbers wait for a man, so the company of priests murder in the way by consent: for they commit lewdness.</i> | As marauders lie in ambush for a man, so do bands of priests. They murder on the road to Shechem, carrying out their wicked schemes. |
| 10 | <i>I have seen an horrible thing in the house of Israel: there is the whoredom of Ephraim, Israel is defiled.</i> | I have seen a horrible thing in the house of Israel: there is the whoredom of Ephraim; Israel is defiled. |
| 11 | <i>Also, O Judah, he hath set an harvest for thee, when I returned the captivity of my people.</i> | Also for you, Judah, a harvest is appointed. When I bring again the captivity of My people, |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 5:18; Deut 32:39; 1 Sam 2:6; Lam 3:40-41; Hos 14:4
- v2 — 2 Kgs 20:5; 1 Cor 15:4; Isa 26:19; Ezek 37:11-13; Hos 13:14
- v3 — Jer 24:7; Hos 14:5; Ps 72:6; Prov 2:1-5; Phil 3:13-15
- v4 — Hos 11:8; Hos 13:3; Ps 78:34-37; Ps 106:12-13
- v5 — Jer 23:29; Jer 1:10; Jer 5:14; Heb 4:12
- v6 — Matt 9:13; Matt 12:7; Prov 21:3; 1 Sam 15:22; Amos 5:21
- v7 — Gen 3:11; Hos 5:7; Hos 8:1; Job 31:33; Jer 9:6
- v10 — Hos 5:3
- v11 — Joel 3:13

Chapter 7

The iniquity of Ephraim and the wickedness of Samaria are exposed — they are full of deceit, theft, and drunkenness. Their kings fall one after another, and none of them call on the LORD. Ephraim is like a cake not turned — half-baked, mixing himself among the peoples, calling to Egypt and Assyria instead of the LORD.

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| 1 | <i>When I would have healed Israel, then the iniquity of Ephraim was discovered, and the wickedness of Samaria: for they commit falsehood; and the thief cometh in, and the troop of robbers spoileth without.</i> | when I would heal Israel, the iniquity of Ephraim is exposed and the crimes of Samaria revealed. They practice deceit; thieves break into houses, bandits rob in the streets. |
| 2 | <i>And they consider not in their hearts that I remember all their wickedness: now their own doings have beset them about; they are before my face.</i> | But they do not realize that I remember all their evil deeds. Their sins engulf them; they are always before Me. |
| 3 | <i>They make the king glad with their wickedness, and the princes with their lies.</i> | They delight the king with their wickedness, the princes with their lies. |
| 4 | <i>They are all adulterers, as an oven heated by the baker, who ceaseth from raising after he hath kneaded the dough, until it be leavened.</i> | They are all adulterers, burning like an oven whose fire the baker need not stir from the kneading of the dough till it rises. |
| 5 | <i>In the day of our king the princes have made him sick with bottles of wine; he stretched out his hand with scorn.</i> | On the day of the festival of our king, the princes become inflamed with wine, and he joins hands with the mockers. |
| 6 | <i>For they have made ready their heart like an oven, whiles they lie in wait: their baker sleepeth all the night; in the morning it burneth as a flaming fire.</i> | Their hearts are like an oven; they approach him with intrigue. Their passion smolders all night; in the morning it blazes like a flaming fire. |
| 7 | <i>They are all hot as an oven, and have devoured their judges; all their kings are fallen: there is none among them that calleth unto me.</i> | All of them are hot as an oven; they devour their rulers. All their kings fall, and none of them calls on Me. |
| 8 | <i>Ephraim, he hath mixed himself among the people; Ephraim is a cake not turned.</i> | Ephraim mixes with the nations; Ephraim is a flat loaf not turned over. |

- 9 *Strangers have devoured his strength, and he knoweth it not: yea, gray hairs are here and there upon him, yet he knoweth not.* Foreigners sap his strength, but he does not realize it. His hair is sprinkled with gray, but he does not notice.
- 10 *And the pride of Israel testifieth to his face: and they do not return to the LORD their God, nor seek him for all this.* Israel's arrogance testifies against Him, but despite all this He does not return to the LORD His God or seek Him.
- 11 *Ephraim also is like a silly dove without heart: they call to Egypt, they go to Assyria.* Ephraim is like a dove, easily deceived and senseless — now calling to Egypt, now turning to Assyria.
- 12 *When they shall go, I will spread my net upon them; I will bring them down as the fowls of the heaven; I will chastise them, as their congregation hath heard.* When they go, I will throw My net over them; I will pull them down like birds in the sky. When I hear them flocking together, I will catch them.
- 13 *Woe unto them! for they have fled from me: destruction unto them! because they have transgressed against me: though I have redeemed them, yet they have spoken lies against me.* Woe to them, because they have fled from Me! Destruction to them, because they have rebelled against Me! I long to redeem them but they speak lies against Me.
- 14 *And they have not cried unto me with their heart, when they howled upon their beds: they assemble themselves for corn and wine, and they rebel against me.* They do not cry out to Me from their hearts but wail on their beds. They slash themselves, appealing to their gods for grain and new wine, but they turn away from Me.
- 15 *Though I have bound and strengthened their arms, yet do they imagine mischief against me.* I trained them and strengthened their arms, but they plot evil against Me.
- 16 *They return, but not to the most High: they are like a deceitful bow: their princes shall fall by the sword for the rage of their tongue: this shall be their derision in the land of Egypt.* They do not turn to the Most High; they are like a faulty bow. Their leaders will fall by the sword because of their insolent words. For this they will be ridiculed in the land of Egypt.

Words in this chapter:

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hos 7:13
- v2 — Luke 12:2
- v3 — Rom 1:32
- v4 — Jer 9:2
- v8 — Ps 106:35; Ezra 9:12; Neh 13:23-25; Mal 2:11; Ezra 9:1
- v9 — Hos 8:7
- v10 — Hos 5:5; Isa 9:13
- v11 — Hos 5:13; Hos 12:1
- v12 — Ezek 12:13
- v13 — Hos 9:12
- v14 — Jas 4:3; Job 35:9-10; Jer 3:10; Ps 78:34-37
- v16 — Ps 78:57; Hos 9:3

Chapter 8

The trumpet sounds the alarm — an eagle hovers over the house of the LORD because Israel has broken the covenant and rebelled against the law. They set up kings without the LORD's approval and made idols of silver and gold. Israel has forgotten his Maker and built temples; they will reap the whirlwind.

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| 1 | <i>Set the trumpet to thy mouth. He shall come as an eagle against the house of the LORD, because they have transgressed my covenant, and trespassed against my law.</i> | Put the trumpet to Your lips! An eagle is over the house of the LORD because the people have broken My covenant and rebelled against My law. |
| 2 | <i>Israel shall cry unto me, My God, we know thee.</i> | Israel cries out to Me, "O our God, we acknowledge You!" |
| 3 | <i>Israel hath cast off the thing that is good: the enemy shall pursue him.</i> | But Israel has rejected what is good; an enemy will pursue Him. |

- 4 *They have set up kings, but not by me: they have made princes, and I knew it not: of their silver and their gold have they made them idols, that they may be cut off.* They set up kings without My consent; they choose princes without My approval. With their silver and gold they make idols for themselves — to their own destruction.
- 5 *Thy calf, O Samaria, hath cast thee off; mine anger is kindled against them: how long will it be ere they attain to innocency?* Throw out Your calf-idol, O Samaria! My anger burns against them. How long will they be incapable of purity?
- 6 *For from Israel was it also: the workman made it; therefore it is not God: but the calf of Samaria shall be broken in pieces.* This idol is from Israel! A craftsman has made it; it is not God. It will be broken in pieces, that calf of Samaria!
- 7 *For they have sown the wind, and they shall reap the whirlwind: it hath no stalk: the bud shall yield no meal: if so be it yield, the strangers shall swallow it up.* They sow the wind and reap the whirlwind. The stalk has no head; it will produce no flour. Were it to yield grain, foreigners would swallow it up.
- 8 *Israel is swallowed up: now shall they be among the Gentiles as a vessel wherein is no pleasure.* Israel is swallowed up; now she is among the nations like something no one wants.
- 9 *For they are gone up to Assyria, a wild ass alone by himself: Ephraim hath hired lovers.* For they have gone up to Assyria like a wild donkey wandering alone. Ephraim has sold herself to lovers.
- 10 *Yea, though they have hired among the nations, now will I gather them, and they shall sorrow a little for the burden of the king of princes.* Even though they have sold themselves among the nations, I will now gather them together. They will begin to waste away under the oppression of the mighty king.
- 11 *Because Ephraim hath made many altars to sin, altars shall be unto him to sin.* Ephraim has built many altars for sin offerings, but these have become altars for sinning.

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| <p>12 <i>I have written to him the great things of my law, but they were counted as a strange thing.</i></p> <p>13 <i>They sacrifice flesh for the sacrifices of mine offerings, and eat it; but the LORD accepteth them not; now will he remember their iniquity, and visit their sins: they shall return to Egypt.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For Israel hath forgotten his Maker, and buildeth temples; and Judah hath multiplied fenced cities: but I will send a fire upon his cities, and it shall devour the palaces thereof.</i></p> | <p>I wrote for them the many things of My law, but they regarded them as something foreign.</p> <p>Though they offer sacrifices as gifts to Me, and though they eat the meat, the LORD is not pleased with them. Now He will remember their iniquity and punish their sins. They will return to Egypt.</p> <p>Israel has forgotten their Maker and built palaces; Judah has fortified many towns. But I will send fire on their cities that will consume their fortresses.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

v1 — Hos 6:7; Deut 28:49; Hos 5:8; Jer 4:13

v5 — Hos 10:5; Jer 13:27

v7 — Prov 22:8; Job 4:8; Gal 6:7; Nah 1:3

v8 — Jer 22:28

v9 — Jer 2:24

v10 — Ezek 16:37

v11 — Hos 12:11

v13 — Hos 9:6; Hos 9:9

v14 — Deut 32:18; Jer 17:27

Chapter 9

Israel will not rejoice like other nations, for she has gone a whoring from her God. The days of visitation and recompense have come. The prophet is called a fool, and Ephraim is snared. Because of the greatness of their iniquity, the LORD will cast them away — they will be

wanderers among the nations.

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| 1 <i>Rejoice not, O Israel, for joy, as other people: for thou hast gone a whoring from thy God, thou hast loved a reward upon every cornfloor.</i> | Do not rejoice, O Israel; do not be jubilant like the other nations. For you have gone a whoring from your God; You have loved a reward upon every cornfloor. |
| 2 <i>The floor and the winepress shall not feed them, and the new wine shall fail in her.</i> | Threshing floors and winepresses will not feed the people; the new wine will fail them. |
| 3 <i>They shall not dwell in the LORD's land; but Ephraim shall return to Egypt, and they shall eat unclean things in Assyria.</i> | They will not remain in the LORD's land; Ephraim will return to Egypt and eat unclean food in Assyria. |
| 4 <i>They shall not offer wine offerings to the LORD, neither shall they be pleasing unto him: their sacrifices shall be unto them as the bread of mourners; all that eat thereof shall be polluted: for their bread for their soul shall not come into the house of the LORD.</i> | They will not pour out wine offerings to the LORD, nor will their sacrifices please Him. Such sacrifices will be to them like the bread of mourners; all who eat them will be unclean. This food will be for themselves; it will not come into the temple of the LORD. |
| 5 <i>What will ye do in the solemn day, and in the day of the feast of the LORD?</i> | What will You do on the day of Your appointed festivals, on the feast days of the LORD? |
| 6 <i>For, lo, they are gone because of destruction: Egypt shall gather them up, Memphis shall bury them: the pleasant places for their silver, nettles shall possess them: thorns shall be in their tabernacles.</i> | Even if they escape from destruction, Egypt will gather them, and Memphis will bury them. Their treasures of silver will be taken over by nettles, and thorns will be in their tabernacles. |

- 7 *The days of visitation are come, the days of recompence are come; Israel shall know it: the prophet is a fool, the spiritual man is mad, for the multitude of thine iniquity, and the great hatred.* The days of punishment are coming, the days of reckoning are at hand. Let Israel know this. Because your sins are so many and your hostility so great, the prophet is considered a fool, the inspired man a maniac.
- 8 *The watchman of Ephraim was with my God: but the prophet is a snare of a fowler in all his ways, and hatred in the house of his God.* The prophet, along with my God, is the watchman over Ephraim, yet snares await Him on all His paths, and hostility in the house of His God.
- 9 *They have deeply corrupted themselves, as in the days of Gibeah: therefore he will remember their iniquity, he will visit their sins.* They have sunk deep into corruption, as in the days of Gibeah. God will remember their iniquity; He will punish them for their sins.
- 10 *I found Israel like grapes in the wilderness; I saw your fathers as the firstripe in the fig tree at her first time: but they went to Baal-peor, and separated themselves unto that shame; and their abominations were according as they loved.* When I found Israel, it was like finding grapes in the desert; when I saw your fathers, it was like seeing the early fruit on the fig tree. But when they came to Baal Peor, they consecrated themselves to that shameful idol and became as vile as the thing they loved.
- 11 *As for Ephraim, their glory shall fly away like a bird, from the birth, and from the womb, and from the conception.* Ephraim's glory will fly away like a bird — no birth, no pregnancy, no conception.
- 12 *Though they bring up their children, yet will I bereave them, that there shall not be a man left: yea, woe also to them when I depart from them!* Even if they rear children, I will bereave them of every one. Woe to them when I turn away from them!
- 13 *Ephraim, as I saw Tyrus, is planted in a pleasant place: but Ephraim shall bring forth his children to the murderer.* I have seen Ephraim, like Tyre, planted in a pleasant place. But Ephraim will bring out their children to the slayer.

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| <p>14 Give them, O LORD: what wilt thou give? give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts.</p> <p>15 All their wickedness is in Gilgal: for there I hated them: for the wickedness of their doings I will drive them out of mine house, I will love them no more: all their princes are revolvers.</p> <p>16 Ephraim is smitten, their root is dried up, they shall bear no fruit: yea, though they bring forth, yet will I slay even the beloved fruit of their womb.</p> <p>17 My God will cast them away, because they did not hearken unto him: and they shall be wanderers among the nations.</p> | <p>Give them, LORD — what will You give them? Give them wombs that miscarry and breasts that are dry.</p> <p>Because of all their wickedness in Gilgal, I hated them there. Because of their sinful deeds, I will drive them out of My house. I will no longer love them; all their leaders are rebellious.</p> <p>Ephraim is struck down; their root is withered; they yield no fruit. Even if they bear children, I will slay their cherished offspring.</p> <p>My God will reject them because they have not listened to Him; they will be wanderers among the nations.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Hos 2:9
- v3 — Ezek 4:13; Hos 8:13; Lev 25:23; Jer 2:7
- v4 — Jer 6:20; Hos 8:13; Deut 26:14
- v5 — Isa 10:3
- v6 — Hos 10:8; Isa 5:6
- v7 — Acts 26:24-25; Mic 7:4
- v8 — Ezek 3:17
- v9 — Hos 10:9; Judg 19:16-20:21
- v10 — Jer 11:13
- v15 — Isa 1:23; Hos 4:15; Amos 5:5; Hos 12:11; 1 Sam 7:16
- v16 — Hos 9:11-13
- v17 — Deut 28:64-65; Hos 7:13

Chapter 10

Israel is a luxuriant vine that bears fruit for itself — the more prosperous the land, the more altars and images they built. Their altars will be broken down and their images destroyed. The

LORD calls them to sow in righteousness and reap in mercy, to break up the fallow ground — but they have plowed wickedness and will reap iniquity.

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| <p>¹ <i>Israel is an empty vine, he bringeth forth fruit unto himself: according to the multitude of his fruit he hath increased the altars; according to the goodness of his land they have made goodly images.</i></p> <p>² <i>Their heart is divided; now shall they be found faulty: he shall break down their altars, he shall spoil their images.</i></p> <p>³ <i>For now they shall say, We have no king, because we feared not the LORD; what then should a king do to us?</i></p> <p>⁴ <i>They have spoken words, swearing falsely in making a covenant: thus judgment springeth up as hemlock in the furrows of the field.</i></p> <p>⁵ <i>The inhabitants of Samaria shall fear because of the calves of Beth-aven: for the people thereof shall mourn over it, and the priests thereof that rejoiced on it, for the glory thereof, because it is departed from it.</i></p> <p>⁶ <i>It shall be also carried unto Assyria for a present to king Jareb: Ephraim shall receive shame, and Israel shall be ashamed of his own counsel.</i></p> <p>⁷ <i>As for Samaria, her king is cut off as the foam upon the water.</i></p> | <p>Israel is an empty vine; He brings forth fruit for Himself. The more His fruit increased, the more altars He built; the better His land, the more goodly images they made.</p> <p>Their heart is deceitful, and now they must bear their guilt. The LORD will demolish their altars and destroy their sacred stones.</p> <p>Then they will say, "We have no king because we did not revere the LORD. But even if we had a king, what could He do for us?"</p> <p>They make many promises, take false oaths, and make agreements; therefore lawsuits spring up like poisonous weeds in a plowed field.</p> <p>The people of Samaria fear for the calf-idol of Beth Aven. Its people will mourn over it, and so will its idolatrous priests — those who had rejoiced over its splendor, because it will be taken from them into exile.</p> <p>It will be carried to Assyria as tribute for the great king. Ephraim will be disgraced; Israel will be ashamed of its foreign alliances.</p> <p>Samaria and its king will float away like a twig on the surface of the waters.</p> |
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- 8 *The high places also of Aven, the sin of Israel, shall be destroyed: the thorn and the thistle shall come up on their altars; and they shall say to the mountains, Cover us; and to the hills, Fall on us.* The high places of wickedness will be destroyed — it is the sin of Israel. Thorns and thistles will grow up and cover their altars. Then they will say to the mountains, "Cover us!" and to the hills, "Fall on us!"
- 9 *O Israel, thou hast sinned from the days of Gibeah: there they stood: the battle in Gibeah against the children of iniquity did not overtake them.* Since the days of Gibeah, You have sinned, O Israel, and there you have remained. Did not war overtake the evildoers in Gibeah?
- 10 *It is in my desire that I should chastise them; and the people shall be gathered against them, when they shall bind themselves in their two furrows.* When I please, I will punish them; nations will be gathered against them to put them in bonds for their double sin.
- 11 *And Ephraim is as an heifer that is taught, and loveth to tread out the corn; but I passed over upon her fair neck: I will make Ephraim to ride; Judah shall plow, and Jacob shall break his clods.* Ephraim is a trained heifer that loves to thresh; so I will put a yoke on her fair neck. I will drive Ephraim, Judah must plow, and Jacob must break up the ground.
- 12 *Sow to yourselves in righteousness, reap in mercy; break up your fallow ground: for it is time to seek the LORD, till he come and rain righteousness upon you.* Sow righteousness for yourselves, reap the fruit of mercy, and break up Your unplowed ground; for it is time to seek the LORD, until He comes and showers His righteousness on You.
- 13 *Ye have plowed wickedness, ye have reaped iniquity; ye have eaten the fruit of lies: because thou didst trust in thy way, in the multitude of thy mighty men.* But You have planted wickedness, You have reaped evil, You have eaten the fruit of deception. Because You have depended on Your own strength and on Your many warriors,

14	<i>Therefore shall a tumult arise among thy people, and all thy fortresses shall be spoiled, as Shalman spoiled Beth-arbel in the day of battle: the mother was dashed in pieces upon her children.</i>	the roar of battle will rise against Your people, so that all Your fortresses will be devastated — as Shalman devastated Beth Arbel on the day of battle, when mothers were dashed to the ground with their children.
15	<i>So shall Beth-el do unto you because of your great wickedness: in a morning shall the king of Israel utterly be cut off.</i>	So will it happen to you, Bethel, because your wickedness is great. When that day dawns, the king of Israel will be completely destroyed.

Words in this chapter:

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Hos 8:11; Isa 5:1-7; Hos 12:11; Lev 26:1; Phil 2:21
- v2 — 1 Kgs 18:21; Mic 5:13
- v3 — Hos 10:15
- v4 — Hos 4:2; Amos 6:12; Amos 5:7
- v5 — Hos 9:11; 2 Kgs 23:5; Hos 5:8; Hos 4:15; Hos 8:5-6
- v6 — Hos 5:13; Isa 30:3; Jer 7:24
- v8 — Luke 23:30; Rev 6:16; Isa 2:19; 1 Kgs 12:28-30
- v10 — Ezek 5:13; Hos 4:9; Jer 16:16
- v12 — Jer 4:3-4; Isa 45:8; Jas 3:18; Prov 11:18; Isa 55:6
- v13 — Job 4:8; Gal 6:7-8; Prov 1:31; Prov 22:8; Prov 18:20-21
- v14 — Hos 13:16

Chapter 11

The LORD remembers how He loved Israel as a child and called His son out of Egypt. But the more He called them, the further they went from Him. He taught Ephraim to walk, took them by the arms, drew them with cords of love — yet they refused to return. "How shall I give you up, Ephraim?" His compassion is stirred; He will not execute the fierceness of His anger.

1	<i>When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt.</i>	When Israel was a child, I loved Him, and out of Egypt I called My son.
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- 2 *As they called them, so they went from them: they sacrificed unto Baalim, and burned incense to graven images.* But the more they were called, the more they went away from Me. They kept sacrificing to the Baals and burning incense to carved idols.
- 3 *I taught Ephraim also to go, taking them by their arms; but they knew not that I healed them.* It was I who taught Ephraim to walk, taking them by the arms; but they did not realize it was I who healed them.
- 4 *I drew them with cords of a man, with bands of love: and I was to them as they that take off the yoke on their jaws, and I laid meat unto them.* I led them with cords of human kindness, with ties of love. I lifted the yoke from their neck and bent down to feed them.
- 5 *He shall not return into the land of Egypt, but the Assyrian shall be his king, because they refused to return.* He shall not return into the land of Egypt, but the Assyrian shall be His king, because they refused to return.
- 6 *And the sword shall abide on his cities, and shall consume his branches, and devour them, because of their own counsels.* A sword will flash in their cities; it will devour their false prophets and put an end to their plans.
- 7 *And my people are bent to backsliding from me: though they called them to the most High, none at all would exalt him.* My people are bent to backsliding from Me. Though they call to the Most High, none at all would exalt Him.
- 8 *How shall I give thee up, Ephraim? how shall I deliver thee, Israel? how shall I make thee as Admah? how shall I set thee as Zeboim? mine heart is turned within me, my repentings are kindled together.* How can I give You up, Ephraim? How can I hand You over, Israel? How can I treat You like Admah? How can I make You like Zeboim? My heart is changed within Me; all My compassion is aroused.
- 9 *I will not execute the fierceness of mine anger, I will not return to destroy Ephraim: for I am God, and not man; the Holy One in the midst of thee: and I will not enter into the city.* I will not carry out My fierce anger; I will not destroy Ephraim again. For I am God, and not a man — the Holy One among You. I will not come against their cities.

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| <p>10 <i>They shall walk after the LORD: he shall roar like a lion: when he shall roar, then the children shall tremble from the west.</i></p> <p>11 <i>They shall tremble as a bird out of Egypt, and as a dove out of the land of Assyria: and I will place them in their houses, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Ephraim compasseth me about with lies, and the house of Israel with deceit: but Judah yet ruleth with God, and is faithful with the saints.</i></p> | <p>They will follow the LORD; He will roar like a lion. When He roars, His children will come trembling from the west.</p> <p>They will come trembling like birds from Egypt, like doves from Assyria. I will settle them in their homes, declares the LORD.</p> <p>Ephraim has surrounded Me with lies, and the house of Israel with deceit. But Judah yet rules with God and is faithful with the saints.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 2:15; Ex 4:22; Hos 13:4
- v2 — Jer 18:15; Hos 2:13
- v3 — Ex 15:26; Jer 30:17; Deut 1:31
- v4 — John 12:32; Lev 26:13; 2 Cor 5:14
- v5 — Hos 7:16; Hos 8:13
- v7 — Jer 8:5
- v8 — Jer 31:20; Matt 23:37; Hos 6:4; Deut 32:36; Deut 29:23
- v9 — Num 23:19; Isa 55:8-9; Mic 7:18-20; Jer 30:11; Isa 12:6
- v10 — Joel 3:16; Amos 1:2; Isa 31:4; Jer 25:30
- v11 — Isa 11:11; Zech 10:10; Isa 60:8

Chapter 12

Ephraim feeds on wind and pursues the east wind — making treaties with Assyria and sending oil to Egypt. The LORD has a controversy with Judah as well. Jacob wrestled with the angel and prevailed; the LORD brought Israel out of Egypt by a prophet, and by a prophet He preserved them. Ephraim has provoked the LORD bitterly, and his blood will be left on him.

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| <p>1 <i>Ephraim feedeth on wind, and followeth after the east wind: he daily increaseth lies and desolation; and they do make a covenant with the Assyrians, and oil is carried into Egypt.</i></p> <p>2 <i>The LORD hath also a controversy with Judah, and will punish Jacob according to his ways; according to his doings will he recompense him.</i></p> <p>3 <i>He took his brother by the heel in the womb, and by his strength he had power with God:</i></p> <p>4 <i>Yea, he had power over the angel, and prevailed: he wept, and made supplication unto him: he found him in Beth-el, and there he spake with us;</i></p> <p>5 <i>Even the LORD God of hosts; the LORD is his memorial.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Therefore turn thou to thy God: keep mercy and judgment, and wait on thy God continually.</i></p> <p>7 <i>He is a merchant, the balances of deceit are in his hand: he loveth to oppress.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Ephraim said, Yet I am become rich, I have found me out substance: in all my labours they shall find none iniquity in me that were sin.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And I that am the LORD thy God from the land of Egypt will yet make thee to dwell in tabernacles, as in the days of the solemn feast.</i></p> | <p>Ephraim feeds on the wind; He pursues the east wind all day and multiplies lies and violence. He makes a treaty with Assyria and sends olive oil to Egypt.</p> <p>The LORD has a charge to bring against Judah; He will punish Jacob according to his ways and repay him according to His deeds.</p> <p>In the womb He grasped His brother's heel; as a man he struggled with God.</p> <p>He struggled with the angel and overcame him; he wept and begged for His favor. He met God at Bethel, and there God spoke with Him —</p> <p>the LORD God Almighty, the LORD is His name of renown!</p> <p>But You must return to Your God; maintain love and justice, and wait for Your God always.</p> <p>The merchant uses dishonest scales and loves to defraud.</p> <p>Ephraim boasts, "I am very rich; I have become wealthy. With all my wealth they will not find in me any iniquity or sin."</p> <p>I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of Egypt. I will yet make You to dwell in tabernacles, as in the days of the solemn feast.</p> |
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| <p>10 <i>I have also spoken by the prophets, and I have multiplied visions, and used similitudes, by the ministry of the prophets.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Is there iniquity in Gilead? surely they are vanity: they sacrifice bullocks in Gilgal; yea, their altars are as heaps in the furrows of the fields.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And Jacob fled into the country of Syria, and Israel served for a wife, and for a wife he kept sheep.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And by a prophet the LORD brought Israel out of Egypt, and by a prophet was he preserved.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Ephraim provoked him to anger most bitterly: therefore shall he leave his blood upon him, and his reproach shall his Lord return unto him.</i></p> | <p>I spoke to the prophets, gave them many visions, and told parables through them.</p> <p>Is Gilead wicked? Its people are worthless! Do they sacrifice bulls in Gilgal? Their altars will be like piles of stones on a plowed field.</p> <p>Jacob fled to the country of Aram; Israel served to get a wife, and to pay for her he tended sheep.</p> <p>The LORD used a prophet to bring Israel up from Egypt, by a prophet He cared for Him.</p> <p>But Ephraim has aroused His bitter anger; His Lord will leave on Him the guilt of His bloodshed and will repay Him for His contempt.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Gilead (*GIL-ee-ad*) — A mountainous region east of the Jordan River — famous for its healing balm; Jeremiah's lament 'Is there no balm in Gilead?' refers to this area.

Cross-References:

v1 — Hos 11:12

v2 — Mic 6:2

v3 — Gen 25:26

v5 — Ex 3:15

v6 — Mic 6:8; Hos 14:1; Lam 3:25-26; Mic 7:7

v8 — Rev 3:17; Ps 62:10

v10 — 2 Kgs 17:13

v11 — Hos 8:11; Hos 4:15; Hos 6:8

v13 — Acts 3:22-23; Ex 12:50-51; Ps 77:20; Acts 7:35-37; Isa 63:11-14

v14 — Ezek 18:13

Chapter 13

When Ephraim spoke, men trembled — but he sinned through Baal and died. They continue to sin, making molten images. Therefore the LORD will be to them like a lion, like a leopard, like a bear robbed of her cubs. "O Israel, you have destroyed yourself, but in Me is your help." The LORD will ransom them from the power of the grave and redeem them from death.

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| 1 <i>When Ephraim spake trembling, he exalted himself in Israel; but when he offended in Baal, he died.</i> | When Ephraim spoke, men trembled; He was exalted in Israel. But He became guilty of Baal worship and died. |
| 2 <i>And now they sin more and more, and have made them molten images of their silver, and idols according to their own understanding, all of it the work of the craftsmen: they say of them, Let the men that sacrifice kiss the calves.</i> | Now they sin more and more; they make cast idols from their silver, cleverly fashioned images — all of them the work of craftsmen. It is said of these people, "They offer human sacrifices and kiss the calf-idols." |
| 3 <i>Therefore they shall be as the morning cloud, and as the early dew that passeth away, as the chaff that is driven with the whirlwind out of the floor, and as the smoke out of the chimney.</i> | Therefore they will be like the morning mist, like the early dew that disappears, like chaff swirling from a threshing floor, like smoke escaping through a window. |
| 4 <i>Yet I am the LORD thy God from the land of Egypt, and thou shalt know no god but me: for there is no saviour beside me.</i> | But I am the LORD Your God, Who brought You out of Egypt. You shall acknowledge no God but Me, no Savior except Me. |
| 5 <i>I did know thee in the wilderness, in the land of great drought.</i> | I cared for You in the desert, in the land of burning heat. |
| 6 <i>According to their pasture, so were they filled; they were filled, and their heart was exalted; therefore have they forgotten me.</i> | When I fed them, they were satisfied; when they were satisfied, they became proud; then they forgot Me. |
| 7 <i>Therefore I will be unto them as a lion: as a leopard by the way will I observe them:</i> | So I will be like a lion to them, like a leopard I will lurk by the path. |

- 8 *I will meet them as a bear that is bereaved of her whelps, and will rend the caul of their heart, and there will I devour them like a lion: the wild beast shall tear them.* Like a bear robbed of her cubs, I will attack them and rip them open; like a lion I will devour them — a wild animal will tear them apart.
- 9 *O Israel, thou hast destroyed thyself; but in me is thine help.* You are destroyed, O Israel, because you are against Me, against your helper.
- 10 *I will be thy king; where is any other that may save thee in all thy cities? and thy judges of whom thou saidst, Give me a king and princes?* Where is Your king, that He may save You? Where are Your rulers in all Your towns, of whom You said, "Give me a king and princes"?
- 11 *I gave thee a king in mine anger, and took him away in my wrath.* So in My anger I gave You a king, and in My wrath I took Him away.
- 12 *The iniquity of Ephraim is bound up; his sin is hid.* The guilt of Ephraim is stored up; His sins are kept on record.
- 13 *The sorrows of a travailing woman shall come upon him: he is an unwise son; for he should not stay long in the place of the breaking forth of children.* Pains as of a woman in childbirth come to him, but he is a child without wisdom; when the time arrives, He does not come to the opening of the womb.
- 14 *I will ransom them from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death: O death, I will be thy plagues; O grave, I will be thy destruction: repentance shall be hid from mine eyes.* I will deliver this people from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death. O death, I will be Your plagues; O grave, I will be Your destruction. I will have no compassion.
- 15 *Though he be fruitful among his brethren, an east wind shall come, the wind of the LORD shall come up from the wilderness, and his spring shall become dry, and his fountain shall be dried up: he shall spoil the treasure of all pleasant vessels.* Even though He thrives among His brothers, an east wind from the LORD will come, blowing in from the desert. His spring will fail and His well dry up. His storehouse will be plundered of all its treasures.

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| 16 <i>Samaria shall become desolate; for she hath rebelled against her God: they shall fall by the sword: their infants shall be dashed in pieces, and their women with child shall be ripped up.</i> | The people of Samaria must bear their guilt, because they have rebelled against their God. They will fall by the sword; their little ones will be dashed to the ground, their pregnant women ripped open. |
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Words in this chapter:

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Kgs 19:18; Isa 46:6; Hos 2:8; Isa 44:17-20; Jer 10:4
- v3 — Ps 1:4; Ps 68:2; Hos 6:4
- v4 — Isa 45:21-22; Hos 12:9; Ex 20:2-3; Isa 43:10-13; Isa 43:3
- v5 — Deut 32:10; Deut 8:15; Deut 2:7; Gal 4:9; Ps 142:3
- v6 — Deut 32:13-15
- v8 — 2 Sam 17:8
- v9 — Jer 2:17; Jer 2:19
- v10 — Hos 8:4; 1 Sam 8:5-6; Hos 10:3
- v13 — Isa 37:3; Isa 26:17; Isa 13:8; Mic 4:9-10; Ps 48:6
- v14 — Isa 25:8; Rev 21:4; 1 Cor 15:52-57; Isa 26:19; Jas 1:17
- v15 — Ezek 19:12
- v16 — 2 Kgs 15:16; 2 Kgs 8:12; Isa 13:16; Ps 137:8-9

Chapter 14

The LORD calls Israel to return and bring words of repentance: "Take away all iniquity, and receive us graciously." Assyria will not save them, and they will no longer call their idols their gods. The LORD will heal their backsliding and love them freely — Israel will blossom like the lily and take root like the cedars of Lebanon.

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| 1 <i>O Israel, return unto the LORD thy God; for thou hast fallen by thine iniquity.</i> | Return, O Israel, to the LORD your God. Your sins have been your downfall! |
| 2 <i>Take with you words, and turn to the LORD: say unto him, Take away all iniquity, and receive us graciously: so will we render the calves of our lips.</i> | Take words with You and return to the LORD. Say to Him: "Forgive all our iniquity and receive us graciously, that we may offer the fruit of our lips. |

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| <p>3 <i>Asshur shall not save us; we will not ride upon horses: neither will we say any more to the work of our hands, Ye are our gods: for in thee the fatherless findeth mercy.</i></p> <p>4 <i>I will heal their backsliding, I will love them freely: for mine anger is turned away from him.</i></p> <p>5 <i>I will be as the dew unto Israel: he shall grow as the lily, and cast forth his roots as Lebanon.</i></p> <p>6 <i>His branches shall spread, and his beauty shall be as the olive tree, and his smell as Lebanon.</i></p> <p>7 <i>They that dwell under his shadow shall return; they shall revive as the corn, and grow as the vine: the scent thereof shall be as the wine of Lebanon.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Ephraim shall say, What have I to do any more with idols? I have heard him, and observed him: I am like a green fir tree. From me is thy fruit found.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Who is wise, and he shall understand these things? prudent, and he shall know them? for the ways of the LORD are right, and the just shall walk in them: but the transgressors shall fall therein.</i></p> | <p>Assyria cannot save us; we will not mount warhorses. We will never again say 'Our gods' to what our own hands have made, for in You the fatherless find mercy."</p> <p>"I will heal their backsliding, I will love them freely, for My anger has turned away from Him.</p> <p>I will be like the dew to Israel; He will blossom like a lily. Like a cedar of Lebanon He will send down His roots; his young shoots will grow. His splendor will be like an olive tree, His fragrance like a cedar of Lebanon.</p> <p>People will again live in His shade. They will flourish like the grain; they will blossom like the vine, and His fame will be like the wine from Lebanon.</p> <p>Ephraim will say, 'What more have I to do with idols?' I will answer Him and care for Him. I am like a green pine tree; Your fruitfulness comes from Me."</p> <p>Who is wise? Let Him understand these things. Who is discerning? Let Him know them. The ways of the LORD are right; the righteous walk in them, but the rebellious stumble in them.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Assyria (*ah-SEER-ee-ah*) — The powerful empire based in northern Mesopotamia — conquered the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; their capitals included Nineveh.

Cross-References:

v1 — Joel 2:12-13; Hos 6:1; Hos 12:6; 2 Chr 30:6-9; Zech 1:3-4

v2 — Ps 51:2-10; Heb 13:15; Job 34:31-32; Job 7:21; Mic 7:18-19

v3 — Ps 10:14; Ps 68:5

v4 — Isa 57:18; Jer 3:22; Isa 12:1; Eph 2:4-9; Zeph 3:17

v5 — Isa 35:2; Isa 27:6; Eph 3:17; Matt 6:28; Isa 44:3

v6 — Ps 52:8

v8 — Job 34:32; Jas 1:17

v9 — Prov 10:29; Ps 107:43; John 8:47; Dan 12:10; Prov 1:5-6

Joel

Author: Joel son of Pethuel — the book names him (Joel 1:1); beyond this, nothing is known of his personal life or circumstances.

Date written: Uncertain — early date c. 835 BC (reign of Joash) is traditional; some place it later. The absence of any mention of Assyria or Babylon may support an early date.

Written to: Judah and Jerusalem, in response to a catastrophic locust plague and drought.

Setting: A devastating locust swarm has stripped the land. The harvest is destroyed, the grain offering cannot be made, and the people face genuine famine. Joel uses this physical disaster as the entry point for one of the OT's most far-reaching prophetic visions — the Day of the LORD.

Where this sits historically: Date uncertain — traditionally placed c. 835 BC during the boy-king Joash's reign in Judah under the regency of Jehoiada the priest, before either the Assyrian or Babylonian crises had reached Jerusalem.

Contemporaries: Under the early date, Elisha was still ministering in the northern kingdom, Athaliah's house had just been overthrown, and Jehu's dynasty ruled Israel.

Big themes:

- The locust plague as divine judgment — the natural disaster is not random; it is the LORD calling His people to repentance
- The Day of the LORD — a recurring theme throughout the prophets; Joel develops it as a day of cosmic darkness, divine judgment on all nations, and ultimate deliverance for God's people
- True repentance — "rend your heart, and not your garments" (2:13); God wants inward return, not outward ritual
- The outpouring of the Spirit — Joel 2:28–32 promises that God will pour out His Spirit on all flesh; Peter quoted this passage on the day of Pentecost (Acts 2:16–21)
- Restoration of the land — God promises to restore the years the locust has eaten (2:25); physical blessing follows spiritual return

Key passages: Joel 1:4; 2:12–13; 2:28–32; 3:14; 3:16

How it fits: Joel is brief but theologically pivotal — his Day of the LORD vision is the framework Amos, Zephaniah, and Revelation all build on. His Spirit-outpouring prophecy is the OT's clearest promise of Pentecost. Peter's identification of Pentecost with Joel 2 makes this short book one of the most NT-quoted of the Minor Prophets.

Chapter 1

A devastating plague of locusts has stripped the land bare — what one swarm left, the next devoured. The fields are ruined, the vines dried up, the grain offering and drink offering cut off

from the house of the LORD. Joel calls the priests and elders to proclaim a solemn fast and cry out to the LORD, for the day of the LORD is at hand.

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| 1 | <i>The word of the LORD that came to Joel the son of Pethuel.</i> | The word of the LORD that came to Joel son of Pethuel. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joel** (JO-el) — "the LORD is God" — A prophet of Judah. His book calls Israel to repentance in the face of a devastating locust plague and warns of the coming Day of the LORD.

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| 2 | <i>Hear this, ye old men, and give ear, all ye inhabitants of the land. Hath this been in your days, or even in the days of your fathers?</i> | Hear this, You elders; listen, all who live in the land. Has anything like this ever happened in your days or in the days of Your ancestors? |
| 3 | <i>Tell ye your children of it, and let your children tell their children, and their children another generation.</i> | Tell it to Your children, and let Your children tell it to their children, and their children to the next generation. |
| 4 | <i>That which the palmerworm hath left hath the locust eaten; and that which the locust hath left hath the cankerworm eaten; and that which the cankerworm hath left hath the caterpillar eaten.</i> | What the locust swarm has left, the great locusts have eaten; what the great locusts have left, the young locusts have eaten; what the young locusts have left, other locusts have eaten. |
| 5 | <i>Awake, ye drunkards, and weep; and howl, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the new wine; for it is cut off from your mouth.</i> | Wake up, You drunkards, and weep! Wail, all You drinkers of wine; wail because of the new wine, for it has been snatched from Your lips. |
| 6 | <i>For a nation is come up upon my land, strong, and without number, whose teeth are the teeth of a lion, and he hath the cheek teeth of a great lion.</i> | A nation has invaded My land, powerful and without number; it has the teeth of a lion, the fangs of a lioness. |
| 7 | <i>He hath laid my vine waste, and barked my fig tree: he hath made it clean bare, and cast it away; the branches thereof are made white.</i> | It has laid waste My vines and ruined My fig trees. It has stripped off their bark and thrown it away, leaving their branches white. |

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| 8 <i>Lament like a virgin girded with sackcloth for the husband of her youth.</i> | Mourn like a young woman dressed in sackcloth grieving for the husband of her youth. |
| 9 <i>The meat offering and the drink offering is cut off from the house of the LORD; the priests, the LORD's ministers, mourn.</i> | Grain offerings and drink offerings have been cut off from the house of the LORD. The priests mourn, those who minister before the LORD. |
| 10 <i>The field is wasted, the land mourneth; for the corn is wasted: the new wine is dried up, the oil languisheth.</i> | The fields are ruined, the ground is dried up; the grain is destroyed, the new wine is dried up, the olive oil fails. |
| 11 <i>Be ye ashamed, O ye husbandmen; howl, O ye vinedressers, for the wheat and for the barley; because the harvest of the field is perished.</i> | Despair, You farmers; wail, You vine growers; grieve for the wheat and the barley, because the harvest of the field is destroyed. |
| 12 <i>The vine is dried up, and the fig tree languisheth; the pomegranate tree, the palm tree also, and the apple tree, even all the trees of the field, are withered: because joy is withered away from the sons of men.</i> | The vine is dried up and the fig tree is withered; the pomegranate, the palm and the apple tree — all the trees of the field — are dried up. Surely the people's joy is withered away. |
| 13 <i>Gird yourselves, and lament, ye priests: howl, ye ministers of the altar: come, lie all night in sackcloth, ye ministers of my God: for the meat offering and the drink offering is withholden from the house of your God.</i> | Put on sackcloth, You priests, and mourn; wail, you who minister before the altar. Come, spend the night in sackcloth, You who minister before my God; for the grain offerings and drink offerings are withheld from the house of Your God. |
| 14 <i>Sanctify ye a fast, call a solemn assembly, gather the elders and all the inhabitants of the land into the house of the LORD your God, and cry unto the LORD.</i> | Declare a holy fast; call a sacred assembly. Summon the elders and all who live in the land to the house of the LORD Your God, and cry out to the LORD. |

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| <p>15 <i>Alas for the day! for the day of the LORD is at hand, and as a destruction from the Almighty shall it come.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Is not the meat cut off before our eyes, yea, joy and gladness from the house of our God?</i></p> <p>17 <i>The seed is rotten under their clods, the garners are laid desolate, the barns are broken down; for the corn is withered.</i></p> <p>18 <i>How do the beasts groan! the herds of cattle are perplexed, because they have no pasture; yea, the flocks of sheep are made desolate.</i></p> <p>19 <i>O LORD, to thee will I cry: for the fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness, and the flame hath burned all the trees of the field.</i></p> <p>20 <i>The beasts of the field cry also unto thee: for the rivers of waters are dried up, and the fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness.</i></p> | <p>What a dreadful day! For the day of the LORD is near; it will come like destruction from the Almighty.</p> <p>Has not the food been cut off before our very eyes — joy and gladness from the house of our God?</p> <p>The seeds are shriveled beneath the clods. The storehouses are in ruins, the granaries have been broken down, for the grain has dried up.</p> <p>How the cattle moan! The herds mill about because they have no pasture; even the flocks of sheep are suffering.</p> <p>To You, LORD, I call, for fire has devoured the pastures in the wilderness and flames have burned up all the trees of the field.</p> <p>Even the wild animals pant for You; the streams of water have dried up and fire has devoured the pastures in the wilderness.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Joel 2:2; Hos 5:1
v3 — Deut 6:7; Ex 13:14; Ps 145:4; Ps 71:18; Ex 10:1-2
v4 — Joel 2:25; Amos 4:9; Isa 33:4; Amos 7:1; Ex 10:4
v5 — Jas 5:1; Luke 21:34-36
v7 — Isa 5:6; Amos 4:9
v9 — Joel 2:14; Joel 2:17
v12 — Isa 16:10; Isa 24:11
v13 — Jer 4:8; Joel 1:8-9
v14 — Joel 2:15-16; Jonah 3:8; Deut 29:10-11; Lev 23:36; 2 Chr 20:3-4

v15 — Isa 13:6-9; Jer 30:7; Zeph 1:14-18; Ezek 7:2-12

v18 — Hos 4:3; Jer 12:4

v19 — Jer 9:10; Ps 50:15

Chapter 2

The trumpet sounds in Zion — a great army like locusts darkens the land, and the day of the LORD is near. Yet the LORD calls: "Turn to Me with all your heart, with fasting, weeping, and mourning — rend your heart and not your garments." If they repent, the LORD will pour out His Spirit on all flesh — sons and daughters will prophesy, old men will dream dreams, young men will see visions.

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| <p>1 <i>Blow ye the trumpet in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain: let all the inhabitants of the land tremble: for the day of the LORD cometh, for it is nigh at hand;</i></p> | <p>Sound the trumpet in Zion; sound the alarm on My holy mountain. Let all who live in the land tremble, for the day of the LORD is coming. It is close at hand —</p> |
| <p>2 <i>A day of darkness and of gloominess, a day of clouds and of thick darkness, as the morning spread upon the mountains: a great people and a strong; there hath not been ever the like, neither shall be any more after it, even to the years of many generations.</i></p> | <p>a day of darkness and gloom, a day of clouds and thick darkness. Like dawn spreading across the mountains, a large and mighty army comes — such as never was in ancient times nor ever will be in ages to come.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>A fire devoureth before them; and behind them a flame burneth: the land is as the garden of Eden before them, and behind them a desolate wilderness; yea, and nothing shall escape them.</i></p> | <p>Before them fire devours; behind them a flame blazes. Before them the land is like the garden of Eden; behind them, a desert waste — nothing escapes them.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The appearance of them is as the appearance of horses; and as horsemen, so shall they run.</i></p> | <p>They have the appearance of horses; they gallop along like cavalry.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Like the noise of chariots on the tops of mountains shall they leap, like the noise of a flame of fire that devoureth the stubble, as a strong people set in battle array.</i></p> | <p>With a noise like that of chariots they leap over the mountaintops, like a crackling fire consuming stubble, like a mighty army drawn up for battle.</p> |

- 6 *Before their face the people shall be much pained: all faces shall gather blackness.* At the sight of them, nations are in anguish; every face turns pale.
- 7 *They shall run like mighty men; they shall climb the wall like men of war; and they shall march every one on his ways, and they shall not break their ranks:* They charge like warriors; they scale walls like soldiers. They all march in line, not swerving from their course.
- 8 *Neither shall one thrust another; they shall walk every one in his path: and when they fall upon the sword, they shall not be wounded.* They do not jostle each other; each marches straight ahead. They plunge through defenses without breaking ranks.
- 9 *They shall run to and fro in the city; they shall run upon the wall, they shall climb up upon the houses; they shall enter in at the windows like a thief.* They rush upon the city; they run along the wall. They climb into the houses; like thieves they enter through the windows.
- 10 *The earth shall quake before them; the heavens shall tremble: the sun and the moon shall be dark, and the stars shall withdraw their shining:* Before them the earth shakes, the heavens tremble, the sun and moon are darkened, and the stars no longer shine.
- 11 *And the LORD shall utter his voice before his army: for his camp is very great: for he is strong that executeth his word: for the day of the LORD is great and very terrible; and who can abide it?* The LORD thunders at the head of His army; His forces are beyond number, and mighty is the army that obeys His command. The day of the LORD is great; it is dreadful. Who can endure it?
- 12 *Therefore also now, saith the LORD, turn ye even to me with all your heart, and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning:* "Even now," declares the LORD, "return to Me with all Your heart, with fasting and weeping and mourning."

- 13 *And rend your heart, and not your garments, and turn unto the LORD your God: for he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and repenteth him of the evil.* Tear Your heart, and not Your garments. Return to the LORD Your God, for He is gracious and merciful, longsuffering, and of great kindness — and He relents from sending calamity.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — "patient endurance toward those who are difficult or rebellious; God's slowness to anger and His willingness to wait for sinners to repent."

- 14 *Who knoweth if he will return and repent, and leave a blessing behind him; even a meat offering and a drink offering unto the LORD your God?* Who knows? He may turn and relent and leave behind a blessing — grain offerings and drink offerings for the LORD Your God.
- 15 *Blow the trumpet in Zion, sanctify a fast, call a solemn assembly:* Sound the trumpet in Zion, declare a holy fast, call a sacred assembly.
- 16 *Gather the people, sanctify the congregation, assemble the elders, gather the children, and those that suck the breasts: let the bridegroom go forth of his chamber, and the bride out of her closet.* Gather the people, consecrate the assembly; bring together the elders, gather the children, those nursing at the breast. Let the bridegroom leave His room and the bride her chamber.
- 17 *Let the priests, the ministers of the LORD, weep between the porch and the altar, and let them say, Spare thy people, O LORD, and give not thine heritage to reproach, that the heathen should rule over them: wherefore should they say among the people, Where is their God?* Let the priests, who minister before the LORD, weep between the temple porch and the altar. Let them say, "Spare Your people, LORD. Do not make Your inheritance an object of scorn, a byword among the nations. Why should they say among the peoples, 'Where is their God?' "
- 18 *Then will the LORD be jealous for his land, and pity his people.* Then the LORD will be jealous for His land and take pity on His people.

- 19 *Yea, the LORD will answer and say unto his people, Behold, I will send you corn, and wine, and oil, and ye shall be satisfied therewith: and I will no more make you a reproach among the heathen:* The LORD will reply to them: "I am sending You grain, new wine, and olive oil, enough to satisfy You fully; never again will I make You an object of scorn to the nations.
- 20 *But I will remove far off from you the northern army, and will drive him into a land barren and desolate, with his face toward the east sea, and his hinder part toward the utmost sea, and his stink shall come up, and his ill savour shall come up, because he hath done great things.* I will drive the northern horde far from You, pushing it into a parched and barren land — its eastern ranks into the Dead Sea and its western ranks into the Mediterranean Sea. And its stench will go up; its smell will rise." Surely He has done great things!
- 21 *Fear not, O land; be glad and rejoice: for the LORD will do great things.* Do not be afraid, land of Judah; be glad and rejoice. Surely the LORD has done great things!
- 22 *Be not afraid, ye beasts of the field: for the pastures of the wilderness do spring, for the tree beareth her fruit, the fig tree and the vine do yield their strength.* Do not be afraid, You wild animals, for the pastures in the wilderness are becoming green. The trees are bearing their fruit; the fig tree and the vine yield their riches.
- 23 *Be glad then, ye children of Zion, and rejoice in the LORD your God: for he hath given you the former rain moderately, and he will cause to come down for you the rain, the former rain, and the latter rain in the first month.* Be glad, people of Zion, rejoice in the LORD Your God, for He has given You the autumn rains because He is faithful. He sends You abundant showers — both autumn and spring rains, as before.
- 24 *And the floors shall be full of wheat, and the fats shall overflow with wine and oil.* The threshing floors will be filled with grain; the vats will overflow with new wine and oil.

- 25 *And I will restore to you the years that the locust hath eaten, the cankerworm, and the caterpillar, and the palmerworm, my great army which I sent among you.* I will repay You for the years the locusts have eaten — the great locust and the young locust, the other locusts and the locust swarm — My great army that I sent among You.
- 26 *And ye shall eat in plenty, and be satisfied, and praise the name of the LORD your God, that hath dealt wondrously with you: and my people shall never be ashamed.* You will have plenty to eat, until You are full, and You will praise the name of the LORD Your God, Who has worked wonders for You; never again will My people be shamed.
- 27 *And ye shall know that I am in the midst of Israel, and that I am the LORD your God, and none else: and my people shall never be ashamed.* Then You will know that I am in Israel, that I am the LORD Your God, and that there is no other; never again will My people be shamed.
- 28 *And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out my spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions:* And afterward, I will pour out My Spirit on all flesh. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, Your old men will dream dreams, Your young men will see visions.
- 29 *And also upon the servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out my spirit.* Even on My servants, both men and women, I will pour out My Spirit in those days.
- 30 *And I will shew wonders in the heavens and in the earth, blood, and fire, and pillars of smoke.* I will show wonders in the heavens and on the earth — blood and fire and billows of smoke.
- 31 *The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the great and the terrible day of the LORD come.* The sun will be turned to darkness and the moon to blood before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD.

- 32 *And it shall come to pass, that
whosoever shall call on the name of
the LORD shall be delivered: for in
mount Zion and in Jerusalem shall be
deliverance, as the LORD hath said,
and in the remnant whom the LORD
shall call.*
- And everyone who calls on the name
of the LORD will be saved; for on
Mount Zion and in Jerusalem there
will be deliverance, as the LORD has
said, even among the survivors whom
the LORD calls.

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Eden (*EE-den*) — The garden God planted in the east as the first human home — meaning 'delight' or 'pleasure'; location east of which God placed cherubim after the Fall.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 2:15; Joel 1:15; 1 Pet 4:7; Mal 4:1; Joel 3:17
v12 — Jas 4:8-9; Isa 55:6-7; Hos 12:6; 2 Chr 7:13-14; Jer 29:12-13
v13 — Ps 86:15; Ps 34:18; Ex 34:6-7; Isa 57:15; Matt 5:3-4
v18 — Zech 8:2; Ps 103:13; Zech 1:14; Jas 5:11; Lam 3:22
v21 — Zeph 3:16-17; Isa 41:10; Isa 54:4; Ps 126:1-3; Jer 33:3
v23 — Jas 5:7-8; Phil 4:4; Lev 26:4; Hos 6:3; Deut 11:14
v25 — Zech 10:6; Joel 1:4-7; Joel 2:2-11
v26 — Rom 10:11; Ps 22:26; Rom 5:5; Deut 12:7; Isa 45:17
v27 — Ezek 37:26-28; Lev 26:11-12; Zeph 3:17; Isa 45:5; Joel 3:17
v28 — Acts 2:16-21; Ezek 39:29; Isa 32:15; Acts 2:39; Acts 2:2-4
v31 — Rev 6:12-13; Matt 24:29; Mal 4:1; Mal 4:5; Joel 3:15
v32 — Rom 10:11-14; Acts 2:20-21; Isa 46:13; Ps 50:15; Rom 11:26

Chapter 3

The LORD will gather all nations into the valley of Jehoshaphat and judge them for scattering His people and dividing His land. The nations are called to beat their plowshares into swords — but the LORD will roar from Zion. In that day the mountains will drip with new wine, the hills will flow with milk, and the LORD will dwell in Zion forever.

- 1 *For, behold, in those days, and in that time, when I shall bring again the captivity of Judah and Jerusalem,* In those days and at that time, when I bring again the captivity of Judah and Jerusalem,
- 2 *I will also gather all nations, and will bring them down into the valley of Jehoshaphat, and will plead with them there for my people and for my heritage Israel, whom they have scattered among the nations, and parted my land.* I will gather all nations and bring them down to the Valley of Jehoshaphat. There I will put them on trial for what they did to My inheritance, My people Israel — because they scattered My people among the nations and divided up My land.
- 3 *And they have cast lots for my people; and have given a boy for an harlot, and sold a girl for wine, that they might drink.* They cast lots for My people and traded boys for harlots; they sold girls for wine to drink.
- 4 *Yea, and what have ye to do with me, O Tyre, and Zidon, and all the coasts of Palestine? will ye render me a recompence? and if ye recompense me, swiftly and speedily will I return your recompence upon your own head;* Now what have you against Me, Tyre and Sidon and all you regions of Philistia? Are you repaying Me for something I have done? If you are paying Me back, I will swiftly and speedily return on your own heads what you have done.
- 5 *Because ye have taken my silver and my gold, and have carried into your temples my goodly pleasant things:* For you took My silver and My gold and carried off My finest treasures to your temples.
- 6 *The children also of Judah and the children of Jerusalem have ye sold unto the Grecians, that ye might remove them far from their border.* You sold the people of Judah and Jerusalem to the Greeks, that you might send them far from their homeland.
- 7 *Behold, I will raise them out of the place whither ye have sold them, and will return your recompence upon your own head:* See, I am going to rouse them out of the places to which you sold them, and I will return on your own heads what you have done.

- 8 *And I will sell your sons and your daughters into the hand of the children of Judah, and they shall sell them to the Sabeans, to a people far off: for the LORD hath spoken it.* I will sell Your sons and daughters to the people of Judah, and they will sell them to the Sabeans, a nation far away." The LORD has spoken.
- 9 *Proclaim ye this among the Gentiles; Prepare war, wake up the mighty men, let all the men of war draw near; let them come up:* Proclaim this among the nations: Prepare for war! Rouse the warriors! Let all the fighting men draw near and attack.
- 10 *Beat your plowshares into swords, and your pruninghooks into spears: let the weak say, I am strong.* Beat Your plowshares into swords and Your pruning hooks into spears. Let the weakling say, "I am strong!"
- 11 *Assemble yourselves, and come, all ye heathen, and gather yourselves together round about: thither cause thy mighty ones to come down, O LORD.* Come quickly, all You nations from every side, and assemble there. Bring down Your warriors, LORD!
- 12 *Let the heathen be wakened, and come up to the valley of Jehoshaphat: for there will I sit to judge all the heathen round about.* Let the nations be roused; let them advance into the Valley of Jehoshaphat, for there I will sit to judge all the nations on every side.
- 13 *Put ye in the sickle, for the harvest is ripe: come, get you down; for the press is full, the fats overflow; for their wickedness is great.* Swing the sickle, for the harvest is ripe. Come, trample the grapes, for the winepress is full and the vats overflow — so great is their wickedness!
- 14 *Multitudes, multitudes in the valley of decision: for the day of the LORD is near in the valley of decision.* Crowds upon crowds in the valley of decision! For the day of the LORD is near in the valley of decision.
- 15 *The sun and the moon shall be darkened, and the stars shall withdraw their shining.* The sun and moon will be darkened, and the stars no longer shine.

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| <p>16 <i>The LORD also shall roar out of Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem; and the heavens and the earth shall shake: but the LORD will be the hope of his people, and the strength of the children of Israel.</i></p> | <p>The LORD will roar from Zion and thunder from Jerusalem; the earth and the heavens will tremble. But the LORD will be a refuge for His people, a stronghold for the people of Israel.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>So shall ye know that I am the LORD your God dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain: then shall Jerusalem be holy, and there shall no strangers pass through her any more.</i></p> | <p>Then You will know that I, the LORD Your God, dwell in Zion, My holy mountain. Jerusalem will be holy; never again will foreigners invade her.</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, that the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, and all the rivers of Judah shall flow with waters, and a fountain shall come forth of the house of the LORD, and shall water the valley of Shittim.</i></p> | <p>In that day the mountains will drip new wine, and the hills will flow with milk; all the rivers of Judah will flow with waters. A fountain will come forth of the house of the LORD and will water the valley of Shittim.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>Egypt shall be a desolation, and Edom shall be a desolate wilderness, for the violence against the children of Judah, because they have shed innocent blood in their land.</i></p> | <p>But Egypt will be desolate, Edom a desert waste, because of violence done to the people of Judah, in whose land they shed innocent blood.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>But Judah shall dwell for ever, and Jerusalem from generation to generation.</i></p> | <p>Judah will be inhabited forever and Jerusalem through all generations.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>For I will cleanse their blood that I have not cleansed: for the LORD dwelleth in Zion.</i></p> | <p>For I will cleanse their blood that I have not cleansed, for the LORD dwells in Zion.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Edom (*EE-dom*) — The territory south of the Dead Sea — Edomites were descendants of Esau (whose nickname was Edom, 'red'); their hostility to Israel is a recurring OT theme.

Philistia (*fih-LIS-tee-ah*) — The coastal plain south of Canaan — home of the Philistines, Israel's persistent enemies; their five main cities were Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Gath, and Ekron.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Zeph 3:19-20; Jer 30:3; Ezek 39:25; Amos 9:14; Jer 29:14
- v2** — Zech 14:2-4; Isa 66:16; Zeph 3:8; Ezek 38:22
- v3** — Nah 3:10; Obad 1:11; Amos 2:6
- v7** — Isa 43:5-6; Jer 23:8
- v10** — Zech 12:8; Mic 4:3; Isa 2:4; 2 Chr 25:8
- v12** — Joel 3:2; Ps 96:13; Isa 3:13; Ps 98:9; Isa 2:4
- v13** — Rev 14:15-20; Hos 6:11; Mark 4:29; Jer 51:33; Isa 63:3
- v14** — Isa 34:2-8; Joel 3:2; Phil 3:2
- v16** — Joel 2:10-11; Amos 1:2; Jer 25:30-31; Prov 18:10; Jer 16:19
- v17** — Joel 2:27; Nah 1:15; Isa 52:1; Rev 21:27; Isa 4:3
- v18** — Zech 14:8; Rev 22:1-2; Isa 35:6; Ezek 47:1-12
- v21** — Rev 21:3; Ezek 36:25; Isa 4:4; Ezek 36:29; Ezek 48:35

Amos

Author: Amos of Tekoa — "burden bearer" — a shepherd ("herdman") and a "gatherer of sycamore fruit" (7:14). He was a country prophet from the southern kingdom of Judah, called by God to leave his flocks and figs and prophesy in the northern kingdom of Israel. He was not trained in any prophetic school: "I was no prophet, neither was I a prophet's son" (7:14).

Date written: c. 760–750 BC, during the reign of Jeroboam II of Israel (793–753 BC) and Uzziah of Judah (792–740 BC). Amos dates his own ministry "two years before the earthquake" (1:1) — possibly the same earthquake remembered two centuries later in Zechariah 14:5. Amos is the chronologically earliest of the writing prophets, among the oldest written sermons in Scripture.

Written to: The northern kingdom of Israel — and especially its corrupt religious center at Bethel and its prosperous nobility in Samaria.

Setting: The northern kingdom is at the peak of material prosperity under Jeroboam II. Borders are expanded; trade is flourishing; the wealthy build summer houses and winter houses, lie on beds of ivory, drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments. But underneath: the poor are sold for a pair of shoes; the helpless are crushed at the gate; merchants use false balances. The religion is feasts and tithes — at Bethel, at Gilgal, at Beersheba — but it is offered to a calf, not to the LORD. God sends Amos, a southerner and a working man with no prophetic pedigree, to declare that the LORD will spare them no longer. Amaziah the priest at Bethel orders Amos to go home; Amos refuses and prophesies the priest's own ruin.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 760–750 BC under Jeroboam II of Israel and Uzziah of Judah, two years before a famous earthquake (1:1), and roughly forty years before the Assyrians destroyed Samaria in 722 BC.

Contemporaries: Hosea was just beginning his ministry in the north, Jonah had recently been sent to Nineveh, and Isaiah and Micah would take up their callings in Judah within a generation.

Big themes:

- The universal scope of God's moral demand — the oracle against the nations in chapters 1–2 sweeps in a circle and lands on Judah and Israel last
- The inseparability of social justice from true worship — the LORD's hatred of religion that ignores oppression of the poor
- The day of the LORD as darkness, not light, for the impenitent (5:18–20)
- The famine of hearing the words of the LORD (8:11) — a more terrible judgment than hunger or thirst
- The LORD's freedom to use unschooled workmen as His prophets (7:14–15)
- The final hope — the raising up of the tabernacle of David that is fallen (9:11)

Key passages: Amos 3:7 (the LORD reveals His secret to His servants the prophets); 4:11 (a firebrand plucked out of the burning); 5:18–24 (the day of the LORD and the demand for justice); 7:14–15 (Amos's defense — "I was no prophet"); 8:11 (the famine of hearing the word of the LORD); 9:11–15 (the tabernacle of David rebuilt and the final restoration)

How it fits: Amos is the Old Testament's strongest prophetic cry for social justice — particularly the protection of the poor against economic and judicial oppression. Amos 9:11 ("the tabernacle of David that is fallen") is quoted by James in Acts 15:16 to establish, from the Old Testament itself, that God always intended to call Gentiles into His people through Christ. Amos demonstrates that the God of Israel is also the God of all the nations — and that He judges every nation, including His own, by the same righteous standard.

Chapter 1

The LORD roars from Zion and pronounces judgment on the nations surrounding Israel: Damascus, Gaza, Tyre, and Edom. For three transgressions and for four, He will not turn away their punishment — because of their cruelties in war, their slave trading, and their unrelenting rage.

- 1

The words of Amos, who was among the herdmen of Tekoa, which he saw concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel, two years before the earthquake.
- The words of Amos, who was among the herdmen of Tekoa, which he saw concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel, two years before the earthquake.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amos** (AY-mos) — "burden bearer" — A shepherd and fig-tree farmer from Tekoa in Judah, called by God to prophesy to the northern kingdom of Israel. He was not a professional prophet but an ordinary working man (see 7:14–15).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tekoa** (teh-KOH-ah) — "pitching of tents" — A small town in the hill country of Judah, about ten miles south of Jerusalem and six miles south of Bethlehem. Amos's home; later the home of the wise woman who pleaded with David for Absalom (2 Samuel 14).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Uzziah** (uh-ZY-ah) — "the LORD is my strength" — King of Judah, c. 792–740 BC; also called Azariah. A largely good king whose reign was long and prosperous, but who was struck with leprosy for proudly entering the temple to burn incense (2 Chronicles 26).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jeroboam** (jair-uh-BOH-am) — "the people contend" — Here, Jeroboam II, son of Joash, king of the northern kingdom of Israel c. 793–753 BC. Not to be confused with the first Jeroboam, who founded the northern kingdom and set up the calf shrines. The second Jeroboam was militarily and economically successful, but morally and religiously corrupt — the setting of Amos's prophecy.

- 2 *And he said, The LORD will roar from Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem; and the habitations of the shepherds shall mourn, and the top of Carmel shall wither.* He said: "The LORD will roar from Zion, and lift up His voice from Jerusalem. The pastures of the shepherds will mourn, and the top of Carmel will wither."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Carmel** (KAR-mel) — "garden, fruitful field" — A fertile mountain ridge in northern Israel running down to the Mediterranean coast near modern Haifa. Famous as the site of Elijah's contest with the prophets of Baal (1 Kings 18). Its proverbial fruitfulness makes the threat of its withering all the more striking.

- 3 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have threshed Gilead with threshing instruments of iron:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they have threshed Gilead with threshing instruments of iron,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — Crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. Amos's signature phrase, "For three transgressions of X, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof," is repeated eight times in chapters 1 and 2 — a deliberate, mounting indictment that finally encircles God's own people Israel.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Damascus** (duh-MAS-kus) — Ancient capital of Syria (Aram), northeast of Israel. Israel's persistent enemy throughout the divided-kingdom period; Hazael and Ben-hadad were two of its most aggressive kings (v4).

- 4 *But I will send a fire into the house of Hazael, which shall devour the palaces of Ben-hadad.* I will send a fire on the house of Hazael, and it will devour the palaces of Ben-hadad.
- 5 *I will break also the bar of Damascus, and cut off the inhabitant from the plain of Aven, and him that holdeth the sceptre from the house of Eden: and the people of Syria shall go into captivity unto Kir, saith the LORD.* I will also break the bar of Damascus. I will cut off the people who live in the plain of Aven, and the one who holds the sceptre from the house of Eden. The people of Syria will go into captivity to Kir," says the LORD.

- 6 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they carried away captive the whole captivity, to deliver them up to Edom:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they carried away the whole population as captives, to deliver them up to Edom,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gaza** (GAH-zah) — "strong place" — The chief city of the five Philistine cities on the Mediterranean coast southwest of Israel. Strategically positioned on the trade route between Egypt and the north.

- 7 *But I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza, which shall devour the palaces thereof:* I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza, and it will devour its palaces.
- 8 *And I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod, and him that holdeth the sceptre from Ashkelon, and I will turn mine hand against Ekron: and the remnant of the Philistines shall perish, saith the Lord GOD.* I will cut off the people who live in Ashdod, and the one who holds the sceptre from Ashkelon. I will turn My hand against Ekron, and the remnant of the Philistines will perish," says the Lord GOD.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Philistines** (FIL-is-teens) — The non-Semitic people who occupied the coastal plain southwest of Israel; their five chief cities were Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Ekron, and Gath. Israel's most persistent enemy throughout the period of the Judges and the early monarchy. Amos says (9:7) that the LORD brought them from Caphtor (Crete) — making clear that even Israel's enemies are under the LORD's sovereign hand.

- 9 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Tyrus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they delivered up the whole captivity to Edom, and remembered not the brotherly covenant:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Tyrus, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they delivered up the whole population of captives to Edom, and did not remember the brotherly covenant,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tyrus** (TY-rus) — The KJV form of Tyre, the great Phoenician trading city on the Mediterranean coast north of Israel. Allied with Israel in David and Solomon's day (the "brotherly covenant"); Hiram of Tyre supplied cedar for the temple. By Amos's day Tyre had broken faith and was trafficking Israelite captives to Edom.

10 *But I will send a fire on the wall of Tyrus, which shall devour the palaces thereof.* I will send a fire on the wall of Tyrus, and it will devour its palaces."

11 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because he did pursue his brother with the sword, and did cast off all pity, and his anger did tear perpetually, and he kept his wrath for ever:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because He pursued His brother with the sword and cast off all pity. His anger tore on without end, and He kept His wrath forever.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Edom** (EE-dum) — "red" — *The nation descended from Esau, Jacob's twin brother (Genesis 25:30; 36:1). Located south and east of the Dead Sea. Their constant hostility toward Israel — "his brother" — is treated by the prophets as a particularly grievous betrayal. The whole book of Obadiah is devoted to Edom's judgment.*

12 *But I will send a fire upon Teman, which shall devour the palaces of Bozrah.* I will send a fire on Teman, and it will devour the palaces of Bozrah."

13 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of the children of Ammon, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have ripped up the women with child of Gilead, that they might enlarge their border:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of the children of Ammon, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they have ripped up the women with child of Gilead, that they might enlarge their border,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ammon** (AM-un) — *The nation descended from Lot's younger daughter (Genesis 19:38). Located east of the Jordan, north of Moab. Their capital was Rabbah (modern Amman, Jordan). Like Moab, Ammon was repeatedly at war with Israel.*

14 *But I will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah, and it shall devour the palaces thereof, with shouting in the day of battle, with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind:* I will kindle a fire on the wall of Rabbah, and it will devour its palaces, with shouting on the day of battle, with a tempest on the day of the whirlwind.

15	<i>And their king shall go into captivity, he and his princes together, saith the LORD.</i>	Their king will go into captivity, He and His princes together," says the LORD.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Zech 14:5; 2 Chr 26:1-23
- v2 — Joel 3:16; Jer 25:30; Amos 9:3; Isa 42:13
- v3 — Amos 1:9; Isa 8:4; Amos 2:6; 2 Kgs 8:12; 2 Kgs 10:32-33
- v5 — 2 Kgs 16:9; Amos 9:7; Jer 51:30
- v6 — 2 Chr 28:18; Amos 1:11; Obad 1:11; Amos 1:9; 1 Sam 6:17
- v7 — Zeph 2:4
- v8 — Ezek 25:16; Isa 14:29-31; Jer 47:4-5; Zeph 2:4-7
- v9 — 1 Kgs 9:11-14; Isa 23:1-18
- v11 — Ezek 25:12-14; Num 20:14-21; 2 Chr 28:17; Joel 3:19; Ps 137:7
- v13 — Hos 13:16; Ezek 25:2-7

Chapter 2

The LORD continues His judgments against Moab and then turns to Judah and Israel. Israel is condemned for selling the righteous for silver and the poor for a pair of shoes, for oppressing the afflicted, and for profaning the LORD's holy name. God reminds them He brought them out of Egypt and raised up prophets among them — yet they silenced the prophets and corrupted the Nazarites.

1	<i>Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because he burned the bones of the king of Edom into lime:</i>	This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because He burned the bones of the king of Edom into lime,
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Moab** (MOH-ab) — *The nation descended from Lot's elder daughter (Genesis 19:37). Located east of the Dead Sea, between Edom and Ammon. Ruth the great-grandmother of David was a Moabitess (Ruth 1:4; Matthew 1:5). The crime named here — burning the bones of the king of Edom to lime — was a violation of common decency even against an enemy, and the LORD judges it.*

- 2 *But I will send a fire upon Moab, and it shall devour the palaces of Kirioth: and Moab shall die with tumult, with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet:* I will send a fire on Moab, and it will devour the palaces of Kirioth. Moab will die in the midst of an uproar, with shouting and with the sound of the trumpet.
- 3 *And I will cut off the judge from the midst thereof, and will slay all the princes thereof with him, saith the LORD.* I will cut off the judge from her midst, and kill all her princes with Him," says the LORD.
- 4 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have despised the law of the LORD, and have not kept his commandments, and their lies caused them to err, after the which their fathers have walked:* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they have despised the law of the LORD and have not kept His commandments, and their lies caused them to err — the lies their fathers walked after —

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Judah** (JOO-dah) — "praise" — *The southern kingdom of God's people, with its capital at Jerusalem. After the death of Solomon the twelve tribes split: ten formed the northern kingdom of Israel; two (Judah and Benjamin) formed the southern kingdom of Judah. Amos's home. The oracle has been circling the pagan nations; now it turns inward — first on Judah, then on Israel.*

- 5 *But I will send a fire upon Judah, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem.* I will send a fire on Judah, and it will devour the palaces of Jerusalem."
- 6 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they sold the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of shoes;* This is what the LORD says: "For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment. Because they sold the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of shoes.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Israel** (IZ-ree-el) — "he strives with God" — *The name God gave to Jacob (Genesis 32:28). Here, the northern kingdom — ten tribes — with its capital at Samaria, its royal house in Jeroboam II, and its calf-shrines at Bethel and Dan. The oracle finally rests where it was always going to rest. Israel's catalog of crimes is far longer than any of the pagan nations'.*

- 7 *That pant after the dust of the earth on the head of the poor, and turn aside the way of the meek: and a man and his father will go in unto the same maid, to profane my holy name:* They pant after the dust of the earth on the head of the poor, and turn aside the way of the meek. A man and his father go in to the same young woman, to profane My holy name.
- 8 *And they lay themselves down upon clothes laid to pledge by every altar, and they drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god.* They lay themselves down on clothes taken in pledge beside every altar, and they drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god.
- 9 *Yet destroyed I the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was strong as the oaks; yet I destroyed his fruit from above, and his roots from beneath.* Yet I destroyed the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and who was strong as the oaks. I destroyed His fruit from above, and His roots from beneath.
- 10 *Also I brought you up from the land of Egypt, and led you forty years through the wilderness, to possess the land of the Amorite.* I also brought You up from the land of Egypt, and led You forty years through the wilderness, to possess the land of the Amorite.
- 11 *And I raised up of your sons for prophets, and of your young men for Nazarites. Is it not even thus, O ye children of Israel? saith the LORD.* I raised up some of Your sons to be prophets, and some of Your young men to be Nazarites. Is it not so, You children of Israel?" says the LORD.
- 12 *But ye gave the Nazarites wine to drink; and commanded the prophets, saying, Prophesy not.* "But You gave the Nazarites wine to drink, and commanded the prophets, saying, 'Do not prophesy.'
- 13 *Behold, I am pressed under you, as a cart is pressed that is full of sheaves.* I am pressed down under You, as a cart is pressed that is full of sheaves.
- 14 *Therefore the flight shall perish from the swift, and the strong shall not strengthen his force, neither shall the mighty deliver himself:* Therefore flight will fail the swift, the strong will not gather His strength, and the mighty will not deliver Himself.

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| <p>15 <i>Neither shall he stand that handleth the bow; and he that is swift of foot shall not deliver himself: neither shall he that rideth the horse deliver himself.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And he that is courageous among the mighty shall flee away naked in that day, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>The one who handles the bow will not stand his ground. The swift of foot will not deliver Himself, and the one who rides the horse will not deliver himself.</p> <p>The one who is courageous among the mighty will flee away naked on that day," says the LORD.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Zeph 2:8-9; Ezek 25:8-9
- v2 — Jer 48:41; Jer 48:24
- v4 — Ezek 20:24; Ezek 20:16; Ezek 20:13
- v5 — Hos 8:14; Jer 17:27
- v6 — Joel 3:3
- v7 — Amos 5:12
- v8 — Deut 24:12-17; Ex 22:26-27
- v9 — Mal 4:1; Job 18:16
- v10 — Deut 2:7; Ex 12:51; Amos 3:1; Acts 7:42
- v11 — Num 6:2-3
- v12 — Amos 7:13; Isa 30:10
- v14 — Jer 9:23

Chapter 3

"You only have I known of all the families of the earth; therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities." The LORD does nothing without revealing His secret to His servants the prophets. Israel's enemies will surround the land, pull down her strongholds, and plunder her palaces — the altars of Bethel will be torn down.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear this word that the LORD hath spoken against you, O children of Israel, against the whole family which I brought up from the land of Egypt, saying,</i></p> | <p>Hear this word that the LORD has spoken against You, children of Israel — against the whole family I brought up from the land of Egypt — saying:</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Egypt** (EE-jipt) — *The land of Israel's bondage and great deliverance. The exodus is the LORD's foundational saving act in the OT, repeatedly invoked by the prophets as the basis of His claim on Israel. Throughout Amos, the LORD reminds Israel: I brought you up out of Egypt — therefore you owe Me obedience.*

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| 2 | <i>You only have I known of all the families of the earth: therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities.</i> | "You only have I known of all the families of the earth — therefore I will punish You for all Your iniquities." |
| 3 | <i>Can two walk together, except they be agreed?</i> | Can two walk together unless they be agreed? |
| 4 | <i>Will a lion roar in the forest, when he hath no prey? will a young lion cry out of his den, if he have taken nothing?</i> | Will a lion roar in the forest when He has no prey? Will a young lion cry out from His den if He has taken nothing? |
| 5 | <i>Can a bird fall in a snare upon the earth, where no gin is for him? shall one take up a snare from the earth, and have taken nothing at all?</i> | Can a bird fall into a snare on the ground where no trap is set for Him? Will a snare spring up from the ground when it has caught nothing at all? |
| 6 | <i>Shall a trumpet be blown in the city, and the people not be afraid? shall there be evil in a city, and the LORD hath not done it?</i> | Will a trumpet be blown in a city, and the people not be afraid? Will there be evil in a city, and the LORD has not done it? |
| 7 | <i>Surely the Lord GOD will do nothing, but he revealeth his secret unto his servants the prophets.</i> | Surely the Lord GOD will do nothing, but He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Secret** (SEE-krit) — *God's hidden counsel — His settled plan, kept from the world but disclosed to those He chooses. The LORD reveals His "secret" to His servants the prophets: He never sends judgment unannounced. Before the lion roars, the herald goes ahead. The Hebrew word (sod) carries the sense of intimate council — the prophet is admitted into the LORD's inner counsel and entrusted with His mind.*

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| 8 | <i>The lion hath roared, who will not fear? the Lord GOD hath spoken, who can but prophesy?</i> | The lion has roared — who will not fear? The Lord GOD has spoken — who can but prophesy? |
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- 9 *Publish in the palaces at Ashdod, and in the palaces in the land of Egypt, and say, Assemble yourselves upon the mountains of Samaria, and behold the great tumults in the midst thereof, and the oppressed in the midst thereof.* Publish in the palaces at Ashdod, and in the palaces in the land of Egypt, and say: "Assemble yourselves on the mountains of Samaria. See the great tumults within her, and the oppressed in her midst."
- 10 *For they know not to do right, saith the LORD, who store up violence and robbery in their palaces.* "For they do not know how to do right," says the LORD, "they who store up violence and robbery in their palaces."
- 11 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; An adversary there shall be even round about the land; and he shall bring down thy strength from thee, and thy palaces shall be spoiled.* Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: "An adversary will be even round about the land. He will bring down Your strength from You, and Your palaces will be plundered."
- 12 *Thus saith the LORD; As the shepherd taketh out of the mouth of the lion two legs, or a piece of an ear; so shall the children of Israel be taken out that dwell in Samaria in the corner of a bed, and in Damascus in a couch.* This is what the LORD says: "As the shepherd takes out of the mouth of the lion two legs, or a piece of an ear, so will the children of Israel be taken out — those who dwell in Samaria in the corner of a bed, and in Damascus on a couch."
- 13 *Hear ye, and testify in the house of Jacob, saith the Lord GOD, the God of hosts,* "Hear and testify in the house of Jacob," says the Lord GOD, the God of hosts,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bethel** (BETH-el) — "house of God" — A town about twelve miles north of Jerusalem. After the division of the kingdom, Jeroboam I set up a golden calf there, with a rival temple and priesthood, so the northern tribes would not return to Jerusalem to worship (1 Kings 12:28–33). By Amos's day it was the chief sanctuary of the northern kingdom — "the king's chapel" (7:13) — and the great target of his prophetic fire.

- 14 *That in the day that I shall visit the transgressions of Israel upon him I will also visit the altars of Beth-el: and the horns of the altar shall be cut off, and fall to the ground.* "that on the day I visit the transgressions of Israel on Him, I will also visit the altars of Bethel. The horns of the altar will be cut off and fall to the ground.
- 15 *And I will smite the winter house with the summer house; and the houses of ivory shall perish, and the great houses shall have an end, saith the LORD.* I will strike the winter house along with the summer house. The houses of ivory will perish, and the great houses will come to an end," says the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Amos 2:10
v2 — Deut 7:6; Ex 19:5-6; Deut 10:15; 1 Pet 4:17; Zech 14:17-18
v3 — 2 Cor 6:14-16; Gen 17:1; Gen 5:22; Gen 6:9
v4 — Hos 11:10; Ps 104:21
v5 — Eccl 9:12
v6 — Isa 45:7; Zeph 1:16; Isa 14:24-27; 2 Cor 5:11; Gen 50:20
v7 — John 15:15; Gen 18:17; Ps 25:14; Rev 1:1; Dan 9:22-27
v8 — Amos 3:4; Jer 20:9; Acts 4:20; Amos 1:2
v9 — Amos 4:1; Amos 6:1; Amos 1:8; 1 Sam 5:1
v10 — Jer 4:22; Zeph 1:9
v14 — 2 Kgs 23:15; Hos 10:5-8
v15 — 1 Kgs 22:39; Jer 36:22; Amos 6:11

Chapter 4

The LORD rebukes the wealthy women of Samaria — the "kine of Bashan" — who oppress the poor and crush the needy. He sent famine, drought, blight, pestilence, and overthrow like Sodom — yet they did not return to Him. "Therefore prepare to meet your God, O Israel."

- 1 *Hear this word, ye kine of Bashan, that are in the mountain of Samaria, which oppress the poor, which crush the needy, which say to their masters, Bring, and let us drink.* Hear this word, You kine of Bashan on the mountain of Samaria, who oppress the poor and crush the needy, who say to their masters, "Bring, and let us drink."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bashan** (BAY-shan) — *The fertile high plateau east of the Sea of Galilee, famous in the OT for its rich pastureland and the fatness of its cattle (Psalm 22:12; Deuteronomy 32:14). "Kine of Bashan" — well-fed, sleek heifers — is Amos's withering nickname for the pampered noblewomen of Samaria, who grow fat by oppressing the poor and demanding that their husbands bring them more wine.*

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| <p>2 <i>The Lord GOD hath sworn by his holiness, that, lo, the days shall come upon you, that he will take you away with hooks, and your posterity with fishhooks.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And ye shall go out at the breaches, every cow at that which is before her; and ye shall cast them into the palace, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Come to Beth-el, and transgress; at Gilgal multiply transgression; and bring your sacrifices every morning, and your tithes after three years:</i></p> | <p>The Lord GOD has sworn by His holiness that the days will come on You when He will take You away with hooks, and Your posterity with fishhooks.</p> <p>You will go out through the breaches in the wall, each cow straight before her, and You will be cast into the palace," says the LORD.</p> <p>"Come to Bethel — and transgress! At Gilgal — multiply transgression! Bring Your sacrifices every morning, and Your tithes every three years.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gilgal** (GIL-gal) — *"circle of stones" — The site of Israel's first encampment after crossing the Jordan under Joshua (Joshua 4:19–20). A place of honorable memory had become, by Amos's day, a center of corrupt cultic worship. Amos's command "come to Bethel and transgress" is bitter irony — go ahead, keep doing your religion; you only multiply your guilt.*

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| <p>5 <i>And offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving with leaven, and proclaim and publish the free offerings: for this liketh you, O ye children of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And I also have given you cleanness of teeth in all your cities, and want of bread in all your places: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving with leaven, and proclaim and publish the freewill offerings — for so You love to do, children of Israel," says the Lord GOD.</p> <p>"I also have given You cleanness of teeth in all Your cities, and want of bread in all Your places. Yet You have not returned to Me," says the LORD.</p> |
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- 7 *And also I have withholden the rain from you, when there were yet three months to the harvest: and I caused it to rain upon one city, and caused it not to rain upon another city: one piece was rained upon, and the piece whereupon it rained not withered.* "I also withheld the rain from You, when there were yet three months to the harvest. I caused it to rain on one city, and caused it not to rain on another. One piece of ground was rained upon, and the piece on which it did not rain withered.
- 8 *So two or three cities wandered unto one city, to drink water; but they were not satisfied: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.* So two or three cities wandered to one city to drink water, but they were not satisfied. Yet You have not returned to Me," says the LORD.
- 9 *I have smitten you with blasting and mildew: when your gardens and your vineyards and your fig trees and your olive trees increased, the palmerworm devoured them: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.* "I have struck You with blasting and mildew. When Your gardens and Your vineyards and Your fig trees and Your olive trees increased, the palmerworm devoured them. Yet You have not returned to Me," says the LORD.
- 10 *I have sent among you the pestilence after the manner of Egypt: your young men have I slain with the sword, and have taken away your horses; and I have made the stink of your camps to come up unto your nostrils: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.* "I have sent among You the pestilence, after the manner of Egypt. Your young men I have slain with the sword, and have taken away Your horses. I have made the stench of Your camps come up into Your nostrils. Yet You have not returned to Me," says the LORD.
- 11 *I have overthrown some of you, as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and ye were as a firebrand plucked out of the burning: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.* "I have overthrown some of You, as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah. You were as a firebrand plucked out of the burning. Yet You have not returned to Me," says the LORD.
- 12 *Therefore thus will I do unto thee, O Israel: and because I will do this unto thee, prepare to meet thy God, O Israel.* "Therefore this is what I will do to You, Israel. And because I will do this to You — prepare to meet Your God, Israel."

- 13 *For, lo, he that formeth the mountains, and createth the wind, and declareth unto man what is his thought, that maketh the morning darkness, and treadeth upon the high places of the earth, The LORD, The God of hosts, is his name.* For He who forms the mountains, and creates the wind, and declares to man what is His thought; who makes the morning darkness, and treads on the high places of the earth — the LORD, the God of hosts, is His name.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 22:12; Amos 6:1; Ezek 39:18; Amos 5:11
v2 — Jer 16:16; Ps 89:35; Hab 1:15-16; Isa 37:29; Amos 6:8
v3 — Ezek 12:5
v4 — Ezek 20:39; Hos 4:15; Num 28:3-4
v5 — Ps 81:12; Lev 22:18-21
v6 — Hag 2:17; Jer 5:3; Isa 9:13
v7 — Ex 9:26; Jer 3:3
v9 — Hag 2:17; Deut 28:22; Joel 1:4
v10 — Deut 28:60; Lev 26:25
v11 — Zech 3:2; Isa 13:19; Gen 19:24-25; Jer 23:14
v12 — 1 Thess 5:2-4; Jas 4:1-10; Amos 9:1-4; Mark 13:32-37; Ezek 13:5
v13 — Amos 5:8; Mic 1:3; Amos 9:6; Isa 47:4

Chapter 5

Amos takes up a lament: "The virgin of Israel is fallen; she shall no more rise." The LORD calls them to seek Him and live — to seek good and not evil, to establish justice in the gate. He despises their feast days and will not accept their offerings. "Let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream."

- 1 *Hear ye this word which I take up against you, even a lamentation, O house of Israel.* Hear this word that I take up against You — a lamentation, house of Israel:
- 2 *The virgin of Israel is fallen; she shall no more rise: she is forsaken upon her land; there is none to raise her up.* "The virgin of Israel is fallen — she will rise no more. She is forsaken on her land; there is none to raise her up."

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| <p>3 <i>For thus saith the Lord GOD; The city that went out by a thousand shall leave an hundred, and that which went forth by an hundred shall leave ten, to the house of Israel.</i></p> <p>4 <i>For thus saith the LORD unto the house of Israel, Seek ye me, and ye shall live:</i></p> | <p>For this is what the Lord GOD says to the house of Israel: "The city that goes out by a thousand will have a hundred left, and the one that goes out by a hundred will have ten left."</p> <p>For this is what the LORD says to the house of Israel: "Seek Me, and You shall live."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Beersheba** (beer-SHEE-bah) — "well of the oath" — A town in the far south of Judah, on the edge of the wilderness; associated with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, who all worshipped the LORD there. By Amos's day Beersheba had also been turned into a popular pilgrim shrine for the northern Israelites. The LORD's command is striking: do not go on pilgrimage to these holy places — seek Me directly, and live.

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| <p>5 <i>But seek not Beth-el, nor enter into Gilgal, and pass not to Beer-sheba: for Gilgal shall surely go into captivity, and Beth-el shall come to nought.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Seek the LORD, and ye shall live; lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour it, and there be none to quench it in Beth-el.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Ye who turn judgment to wormwood, and leave off righteousness in the earth,</i></p> <p>8 <i>Seek him that maketh the seven stars and Orion, and turneth the shadow of death into the morning, and maketh the day dark with night: that calleth for the waters of the sea, and poureth them out upon the face of the earth: The LORD is his name:</i></p> | <p>But do not seek Bethel; do not enter into Gilgal; do not pass to Beersheba. For Gilgal will surely go into captivity, and Bethel will come to nothing."</p> <p>Seek the LORD, and You shall live — or He will break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour it, and there will be no one to quench it in Bethel.</p> <p>You who turn judgment into wormwood, and cast down righteousness to the earth —</p> <p>seek Him who made the seven stars and Orion; who turns the shadow of death into the morning, and makes the day dark with night; who calls for the waters of the sea, and pours them out on the face of the earth — the LORD is His name —</p> |
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- 9 *That strengtheneth the spoiled against the strong, so that the spoiled shall come against the fortress.* who strengthens the spoiled against the strong, so that the spoiled comes against the fortress.
- 10 *They hate him that rebuketh in the gate, and they abhor him that speaketh uprightly.* They hate the one who rebukes in the gate, and they abhor the one who speaks uprightly.
- 11 *Forasmuch therefore as your treading is upon the poor, and ye take from him burdens of wheat: ye have built houses of hewn stone, but ye shall not dwell in them; ye have planted pleasant vineyards, but ye shall not drink wine of them.* Therefore, because You tread on the poor and take from Him burdens of wheat, You have built houses of hewn stone, but You will not dwell in them. You have planted pleasant vineyards, but You will not drink their wine.
- 12 *For I know your manifold transgressions and your mighty sins: they afflict the just, they take a bribe, and they turn aside the poor in the gate from their right.* For I know Your many transgressions and Your mighty sins. You afflict the just, You take a bribe, and You turn aside the poor in the gate from their right.
- 13 *Therefore the prudent shall keep silence in that time; for it is an evil time.* Therefore the prudent will keep silent in that time, for it is an evil time.
- 14 *Seek good, and not evil, that ye may live: and so the LORD, the God of hosts, shall be with you, as ye have spoken.* Seek good, and not evil, that You may live. And so the LORD, the God of hosts, will be with You, as You have said.
- 15 *Hate the evil, and love the good, and establish judgment in the gate: it may be that the LORD God of hosts will be gracious unto the remnant of Joseph.* Hate the evil, and love the good, and establish judgment in the gate. It may be that the LORD God of hosts will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph.

- 16 *Therefore the LORD, the God of hosts, the Lord, saith thus; Wailing shall be in all streets; and they shall say in all the highways, Alas! alas! and they shall call the husbandman to mourning, and such as are skilful of lamentation to wailing.* Therefore this is what the LORD, the God of hosts, the Lord, says: "Wailing will be in all streets, and in all the highways they will say, 'Alas! Alas!' They will call the husbandman to mourning, and such as are skilful of lamentation to wailing.
- 17 *And in all vineyards shall be wailing: for I will pass through thee, saith the LORD.* And in all vineyards there will be wailing — for I will pass through Your midst," says the LORD.
- 18 *Woe unto you that desire the day of the LORD! to what end is it for you? the day of the LORD is darkness, and not light.* Woe to You who desire the day of the LORD! To what end is it for You? The day of the LORD is darkness, and not light.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **The day of the LORD** — A great biblical theme: the day on which the LORD finally and openly intervenes in human history to judge the wicked and vindicate His people. The Israelites of Amos's day were looking forward to it as Israel's triumph and the nations' defeat. Amos turns the doctrine around: for impenitent Israel, the day of the LORD will be darkness, not light — because Israel itself has joined the nations in rebellion. The same theme runs through Joel, Zephaniah, Malachi, and finds its NT fulfillment in the second coming of Christ.

- 19 *As if a man did flee from a lion, and a bear met him; or went into the house, and leaned his hand on the wall, and a serpent bit him.* It will be as if a man fled from a lion, and a bear met him; or went into the house and leaned His hand on the wall, and a serpent bit Him.
- 20 *Shall not the day of the LORD be darkness, and not light? even very dark, and no brightness in it?* Will not the day of the LORD be darkness, and not light? Very dark, and no brightness in it?
- 21 *I hate, I despise your feast days, and I will not smell in your solemn assemblies.* "I hate, I despise Your feast days, and I will not smell in Your solemn assemblies.
- 22 *Though ye offer me burnt offerings and your meat offerings, I will not accept them: neither will I regard the peace offerings of your fat beasts.* Though You offer Me burnt offerings and Your meat offerings, I will not accept them. I will not regard the peace offerings of Your fat beasts.

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| <p>23 <i>Take thou away from me the noise of thy songs; for I will not hear the melody of thy viols.</i></p> <p>24 <i>But let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Have ye offered unto me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, O house of Israel?</i></p> <p>26 <i>But ye have borne the tabernacle of your Moloch and Chiun your images, the star of your god, which ye made to yourselves.</i></p> <p>27 <i>Therefore will I cause you to go into captivity beyond Damascus, saith the LORD, whose name is The God of hosts.</i></p> | <p>Take away from Me the noise of Your songs, for I will not hear the melody of Your viols.</p> <p>But let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream.</p> <p>Did You offer Me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel?</p> <p>But You have borne the tabernacle of Your Moloch and Chiun Your images — the star of Your god — which You made for yourselves.</p> <p>Therefore I will cause You to go into captivity beyond Damascus," says the LORD, whose name is the God of hosts.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4 — Zeph 2:3; 2 Chr 15:2; Jer 29:12-13; Isa 55:3; Ps 14:2
- v5 — Hos 4:15; Amos 8:14; Amos 4:4; Gen 21:33
- v8 — Amos 4:13; Job 9:9; Amos 9:6; Amos 8:9; Ps 104:20
- v10 — 1 Kgs 22:8; Isa 29:21; John 8:45-47
- v11 — Zeph 1:13; Deut 28:30; Mic 6:15; Jas 2:6
- v14 — Josh 1:9; Matt 6:33; Mic 6:8; Phil 4:8-9; Mic 3:11
- v15 — Rom 12:9; 3 John 1:11; Joel 2:14; Ps 97:10; 1 Thess 5:21-22
- v17 — Ex 12:12; Jer 48:33; Isa 16:10
- v18 — Joel 1:15; Joel 2:1-2; Joel 2:31; Jer 30:7; Mal 4:1
- v21 — Isa 1:11-16; Prov 28:9; Lev 26:31; Isa 66:3; Jer 6:20
- v23 — Amos 6:5; Amos 8:3; Amos 8:10
- v24 — Mic 6:8; Jer 22:3; Prov 21:3; Hos 6:6; Mark 12:32-34

Chapter 6

Woe to the complacent in Zion and the overconfident in Samaria — they lie on beds of ivory, feast on lambs and calves, sing idle songs, and drink wine by the bowlful, yet they grieve not over the ruin of Joseph. Therefore they will go into captivity first among the captives, and the revelry of the loungers will cease.

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| <p>1 <i>Woe to them that are at ease in Zion, and trust in the mountain of Samaria, which are named chief of the nations, to whom the house of Israel came!</i></p> <p>2 <i>Pass ye unto Calneh, and see; and from thence go ye to Hamath the great: then go down to Gath of the Philistines: be they better than these kingdoms? or their border greater than your border?</i></p> <p>3 <i>Ye that put far away the evil day, and cause the seat of violence to come near;</i></p> <p>4 <i>That lie upon beds of ivory, and stretch themselves upon their couches, and eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the midst of the stall;</i></p> | <p>Woe to those who are at ease in Zion, and who trust in the mountain of Samaria — those who are named chief of the nations, to whom the house of Israel comes!</p> <p>Pass over to Calneh and see, and from there go to Hamath the great. Then go down to Gath of the Philistines. Are they better than these kingdoms? Is their border greater than your border?</p> <p>You who put far away the evil day, and cause the seat of violence to come near;</p> <p>who lie on beds of ivory, and stretch themselves on their couches; who eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the midst of the stall;</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **David** (DAY-vid) — "beloved" — Israel's greatest king (c. 1010–970 BC), composer of many of the psalms, ancestor of the Messiah. Amos here names David as the model and inventor of sacred musical instruments — a contrast with the rich of Samaria, who use music for self-indulgence rather than for worship. David's name will return at the climax of the book (9:11) in the great promise of the rebuilt "tabernacle of David."

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| <p>5 <i>That chant to the sound of the viol, and invent to themselves instruments of musick, like David;</i></p> <p>6 <i>That drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments: but they are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Therefore now shall they go captive with the first that go captive, and the banquet of them that stretched themselves shall be removed.</i></p> | <p>who chant to the sound of the viol, and invent for themselves instruments of musick, like David;</p> <p>who drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments — but they are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.</p> <p>Therefore they will now go captive with the first who go captive, and the banquet of those who stretched themselves will be removed.</p> |
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- 8 *The Lord GOD hath sworn by himself, saith the LORD the God of hosts, I abhor the excellency of Jacob, and hate his palaces: therefore will I deliver up the city with all that is therein.* The Lord GOD has sworn by Himself, says the LORD the God of hosts: "I abhor the excellency of Jacob, and hate his palaces. Therefore I will deliver up the city and all that is in it."
- 9 *And it shall come to pass, if there remain ten men in one house, that they shall die.* And it will come to pass, if there remain ten men in one house, that they will die.
- 10 *And a man's uncle shall take him up, and he that burneth him, to bring out the bones out of the house, and shall say unto him that is by the sides of the house, Is there yet any with thee? and he shall say, No. Then shall he say, Hold thy tongue: for we may not make mention of the name of the LORD.* And a man's uncle will take him up, and the one who burns him, to bring the bones out of the house. He will say to the one in the inner part of the house, "Is there yet any with You?" and He will say, "No." Then He will say, "Hold Your tongue, for we may not make mention of the name of the LORD."
- 11 *For, behold, the LORD commandeth, and he will smite the great house with breaches, and the little house with clefts.* For the LORD commands, and He will strike the great house with breaches, and the little house with clefts.
- 12 *Shall horses run upon the rock? will one plow there with oxen? for ye have turned judgment into gall, and the fruit of righteousness into hemlock:* Will horses run on the rock? Will one plow there with oxen? Yet You have turned judgment into gall, and the fruit of righteousness into hemlock —
- 13 *Ye which rejoice in a thing of nought, which say, Have we not taken to us horns by our own strength?* you who rejoice in a thing of nothing, who say, "Have we not taken to us horns by our own strength?"
- 14 *But, behold, I will raise up against you a nation, O house of Israel, saith the LORD the God of hosts; and they shall afflict you from the entering in of Hemath unto the river of the wilderness.* "For I will raise up against You a nation, house of Israel," says the LORD the God of hosts, "and they will afflict You from the entrance of Hamath to the river of the wilderness."

Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

- v1 — Jas 5:5; Isa 32:9-11; Luke 12:17-20; Amos 4:1; Ex 19:5-6
 v2 — Nah 3:8; 2 Kgs 18:34; Gen 10:10
 v3 — Amos 9:10; Isa 56:12; Ezek 12:27
 v5 — Isa 5:12; Amos 5:23
 v8 — Jer 51:14; Amos 4:2; Amos 8:7; Ps 47:4; Jer 22:5
 v10 — Amos 8:3; 1 Sam 31:12
 v11 — Amos 3:15; Isa 55:11
 v12 — Amos 5:7; Hos 10:4
 v14 — 1 Kgs 8:65; 2 Kgs 14:25

Chapter 7

The LORD shows Amos three visions: a plague of grasshoppers and a fire — both of which He relents from after Amos intercedes — and a plumb line set against Israel, which He will not pass by again. Amaziah the priest of Bethel opposes Amos, but Amos replies that the LORD took him from following the flock and sent him to prophesy against Israel.

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| <p>1 <i>Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me; and, behold, he formed grasshoppers in the beginning of the shooting up of the latter growth; and, lo, it was the latter growth after the king's mowings.</i></p> | <p>This is what the Lord GOD showed me: He was forming grasshoppers at the beginning of the shooting up of the latter growth — the latter growth after the king's mowings.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it came to pass, that when they had made an end of eating the grass of the land, then I said, O Lord GOD, forgive, I beseech thee: by whom shall Jacob arise? for he is small.</i></p> | <p>When they had made an end of eating the grass of the land, then I said, "Lord GOD, forgive, I beseech You! By whom will Jacob arise? For he is small."</p> |
| <p>3 <i>The LORD repented for this: It shall not be, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>The LORD repented concerning this. "It will not be," said the LORD.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me: and, behold, the Lord GOD called to contend by fire, and it devoured the great deep, and did eat up a part.</i></p> | <p>This is what the Lord GOD showed me: the Lord GOD called to contend by fire, and it devoured the great deep, and consumed a part.</p> |

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| <p>5 <i>Then said I, O Lord GOD, cease, I beseech thee: by whom shall Jacob arise? for he is small.</i></p> <p>6 <i>The LORD repented for this: This also shall not be, saith the Lord GOD.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Thus he shewed me: and, behold, the LORD stood upon a wall made by a plumbline, with a plumbline in his hand.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And the LORD said unto me, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A plumbline. Then said the LORD, Behold, I will set a plumbline in the midst of my people Israel: I will not again pass by them any more:</i></p> <p>9 <i>And the high places of Isaac shall be desolate, and the sanctuaries of Israel shall be laid waste; and I will rise against the house of Jeroboam with the sword.</i></p> | <p>Then I said, "Lord GOD, cease, I beseech You! By whom will Jacob arise? For he is small."</p> <p>The LORD repented concerning this. "This also will not be," said the Lord GOD.</p> <p>This is what He showed me: the Lord stood on a wall made by a plumbline, with a plumbline in His hand.</p> <p>The LORD said to me, "Amos, what do you see?" And I said, "A plumbline." Then the Lord said, "I will set a plumbline in the midst of My people Israel. I will not again pass by them any more.</p> <p>The high places of Isaac will be desolate, and the sanctuaries of Israel will be laid waste. I will rise against the house of Jeroboam with the sword."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amaziah** (am-uh-ZY-ah) — "the LORD is mighty" — *The priest of Bethel (the king's chapel) in the days of Jeroboam II. He sends word to the king accusing Amos of conspiracy, and orders Amos to flee back to Judah and prophesy there for his bread. Amos answers him with one of the most striking self-defenses in all Scripture (vv14–15) — and then with the LORD's word of personal judgment on Amaziah himself (v17).*

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| <p>10 <i>Then Amaziah the priest of Beth-el sent to Jeroboam king of Israel, saying, Amos hath conspired against thee in the midst of the house of Israel: the land is not able to bear all his words.</i></p> | <p>Then Amaziah the priest of Bethel sent to Jeroboam king of Israel, saying, "Amos has conspired against you in the midst of the house of Israel. The land is not able to bear all his words.</p> |
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| <p>11 <i>For thus Amos saith, Jeroboam shall die by the sword, and Israel shall surely be led away captive out of their own land.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Also Amaziah said unto Amos, O thou seer, go, flee thee away into the land of Judah, and there eat bread, and prophesy there:</i></p> <p>13 <i>But prophesy not again any more at Beth-el: for it is the king's chapel, and it is the king's court.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then answered Amos, and said to Amaziah, I was no prophet, neither was I a prophet's son; but I was an herdman, and a gatherer of sycomore fruit:</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the LORD took me as I followed the flock, and the LORD said unto me, Go, prophesy unto my people Israel.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Now therefore hear thou the word of the LORD: Thou sayest, Prophesy not against Israel, and drop not thy word against the house of Isaac.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD; Thy wife shall be an harlot in the city, and thy sons and thy daughters shall fall by the sword, and thy land shall be divided by line; and thou shalt die in a polluted land: and Israel shall surely go into captivity forth of his land.</i></p> | <p>For this is what Amos says: 'Jeroboam will die by the sword, and Israel will surely be led away captive out of their own land.' "</p> <p>Amaziah also said to Amos, "Seer, go! Flee away to the land of Judah; there eat bread, and prophesy there.</p> <p>But do not prophesy any more at Bethel, for it is the king's chapel and the king's court."</p> <p>Then Amos answered, and said to Amaziah, "I was no prophet, neither was I a prophet's son. I was an herdman, and a gatherer of sycomore fruit.</p> <p>The LORD took me as I followed the flock, and the LORD said to me, 'Go, prophesy to My people Israel.'</p> <p>Now therefore hear the word of the LORD. You say, 'Do not prophesy against Israel, and drop not Your word against the house of Isaac.'</p> <p>Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'Your wife will be a harlot in the city, and Your sons and Your daughters will fall by the sword. Your land will be divided by line, and You Yourself will die in a polluted land. And Israel will surely go into captivity, away from His land.' "</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 1:4
- v2 — Isa 37:4
- v3 — Deut 32:36; Jonah 3:10
- v7 — 2 Kgs 21:13
- v8 — Amos 8:2; Lam 2:8; Jer 15:6; Ezek 7:2-9
- v10 — Jer 38:4; 1 Kgs 12:31-32
- v13 — 1 Kgs 12:32; Amos 2:12
- v14 — Amos 1:1; Zech 13:5
- v15 — 2 Sam 7:8
- v16 — Ezek 20:46
- v17 — Hos 9:3; 2 Kgs 17:6; Ezek 4:13; Jer 28:16

Chapter 8

The LORD shows Amos a basket of summer fruit — the end has come for Israel. He condemns those who trample the needy, who cannot wait for the Sabbath to end so they can cheat with dishonest scales. The LORD will send a famine — not of bread or water, but of hearing the words of the LORD — and they will search for His word but not find it.

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| 1 | <i>Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me: and behold a basket of summer fruit.</i> | This is what the Lord GOD showed me: a basket of summer fruit. |
| 2 | <i>And he said, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A basket of summer fruit. Then said the LORD unto me, The end is come upon my people of Israel; I will not again pass by them any more.</i> | And He said, "Amos, what do you see?" And I said, "A basket of summer fruit." Then the LORD said to me, "The end is come on My people Israel. I will not again pass by them any more. |
| 3 | <i>And the songs of the temple shall be howlings in that day, saith the Lord GOD: there shall be many dead bodies in every place; they shall cast them forth with silence.</i> | The songs of the temple will be howlings on that day," says the Lord GOD. "There will be many dead bodies in every place; they will cast them forth in silence." |
| 4 | <i>Hear this, O ye that swallow up the needy, even to make the poor of the land to fail,</i> | Hear this, You who swallow up the needy, even to make the poor of the land to fail — |

- 5 *Saying, When will the new moon be gone, that we may sell corn? and the sabbath, that we may set forth wheat, making the ephah small, and the shekel great, and falsifying the balances by deceit?* saying, "When will the new moon be gone, that we may sell corn? And the sabbath, that we may set forth wheat? — making the ephah small, and the shekel great, and falsifying the balances by deceit,
- 6 *That we may buy the poor for silver, and the needy for a pair of shoes; yea, and sell the refuse of the wheat?* that we may buy the poor for silver, and the needy for a pair of shoes — and sell the refuse of the wheat?"
- 7 *The LORD hath sworn by the excellency of Jacob, Surely I will never forget any of their works.* The LORD has sworn by the excellency of Jacob: "Surely I will never forget any of their works.
- 8 *Shall not the land tremble for this, and every one mourn that dwelleth therein? and it shall rise up wholly as a flood; and it shall be cast out and drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.* Will not the land tremble for this, and every one who dwells in it mourn? It will rise up wholly as a flood; it will be cast out and drowned, as by the flood of Egypt."
- 9 *And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the Lord GOD, that I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day:* "And it will come to pass on that day," says the Lord GOD, "that I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day.
- 10 *And I will turn your feasts into mourning, and all your songs into lamentation; and I will bring up sackcloth upon all loins, and baldness upon every head; and I will make it as the mourning of an only son, and the end thereof as a bitter day.* I will turn Your feasts into mourning, and all Your songs into lamentation. I will bring up sackcloth on all loins, and baldness on every head. I will make it as the mourning of an only son, and the end of it as a bitter day.
- 11 *Behold, the days come, saith the Lord GOD, that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the LORD:* "The days are coming," says the Lord GOD, "when I will send a famine in the land — not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the LORD.

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| <p>12 <i>And they shall wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east, they shall run to and fro to seek the word of the LORD, and shall not find it.</i></p> <p>13 <i>In that day shall the fair virgins and young men faint for thirst.</i></p> <p>14 <i>They that swear by the sin of Samaria, and say, Thy god, O Dan, liveth; and, The manner of Beer-sheba liveth; even they shall fall, and never rise up again.</i></p> | <p>They will wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east. They will run to and fro to seek the word of the LORD, and will not find it.</p> <p>On that day the fair virgins and young men will faint for thirst.</p> <p>Those who swear by the sin of Samaria, and say, 'As Your god lives, Dan,' and, 'As the manner of Beersheba lives' — they will fall, and never rise up again."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Amos 7:8
- v3 — Amos 5:23; Amos 6:9-10
- v4 — Prov 30:14; Ps 14:4; Amos 5:11; Isa 32:6-7
- v5 — Neh 13:15-21; Hos 12:7; Mic 6:10-11; Deut 25:13-16; Lev 19:36
- v6 — Amos 2:6
- v7 — Amos 6:8; Hos 9:9; Hos 8:13; Hos 7:2
- v8 — Amos 9:5; Jer 46:8; Hos 4:3; Ps 18:7
- v9 — Mark 15:33; Matt 27:45; Jer 15:9; Luke 23:44; Mic 3:6
- v10 — Jer 6:26; Zech 12:10
- v11 — 1 Sam 3:1; Ps 74:9; 2 Chr 15:3; 1 Sam 28:6; Ezek 7:26
- v12 — Rom 11:7-10
- v14 — Amos 5:5; 1 Kgs 12:28-29

Chapter 9

Amos sees the Lord standing beside the altar, commanding destruction — none will escape, whether they dig into hell or climb to heaven. Yet the LORD will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob. In that day He will raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen, and Israel will be planted on their own land and never again be pulled up.

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| <p>1 <i>I saw the LORD standing upon the altar: and he said, Smite the lintel of the door, that the posts may shake: and cut them in the head, all of them; and I will slay the last of them with the sword: he that fleeth of them shall not flee away, and he that escapeth of them shall not be delivered.</i></p> <p>2 <i>Though they dig into hell, thence shall mine hand take them; though they climb up to heaven, thence will I bring them down:</i></p> <p>3 <i>And though they hide themselves in the top of Carmel, I will search and take them out thence; and though they be hid from my sight in the bottom of the sea, thence will I command the serpent, and he shall bite them:</i></p> <p>4 <i>And though they go into captivity before their enemies, thence will I command the sword, and it shall slay them: and I will set mine eyes upon them for evil, and not for good.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And the Lord GOD of hosts is he that toucheth the land, and it shall melt, and all that dwell therein shall mourn: and it shall rise up wholly like a flood; and shall be drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.</i></p> <p>6 <i>It is he that buildeth his stories in the heaven, and hath founded his troop in the earth; he that calleth for the waters of the sea, and poureth them out upon the face of the earth: The LORD is his name.</i></p> | <p>I saw the Lord standing on the altar, and He said: "Smite the lintel of the door, that the posts may shake. Cut them on the head, all of them — and I will slay the last of them with the sword. He who flees of them will not flee away, and he who escapes of them will not be delivered.</p> <p>Though they dig into hell, from there shall My hand take them. Though they climb up to heaven, from there will I bring them down.</p> <p>Though they hide themselves on the top of Carmel, I will search and take them out from there. Though they be hidden from My sight in the bottom of the sea, from there will I command the serpent, and he will bite them.</p> <p>And though they go into captivity before their enemies, from there will I command the sword, and it will slay them. I will set My eyes on them for evil, and not for good."</p> <p>The Lord GOD of hosts is He who touches the land, and it melts, and all who dwell in it mourn. It rises up wholly like a flood, and is drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.</p> <p>It is He who builds his stories in the heaven, and has founded His troop on the earth. He calls for the waters of the sea, and pours them out on the face of the earth — the LORD is His name.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ethiopia** (ee-thee-OH-pee-ah) — In the OT, the land south of Egypt — also called Cush — modern Sudan / upper Nile region. Amos's point is sweeping: in the LORD's sovereign view of the nations, Israel is no more privileged by physical descent than the distant Ethiopians. The LORD's care over Israel's exodus is matched by His care over the Philistines and the Syrians — He is the God of all nations, who orders all migrations and judges all peoples by the same standard.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Caphtor** (KAF-tor) — The original homeland of the Philistines, identified with Crete (or possibly Cyprus or the broader Aegean coast). The Philistines were sea-peoples who migrated to Canaan; Amos says here that the LORD Himself brought them — a startling claim that all the movements of all the nations are under His hand.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Kir** (KEER) — The original homeland of the Syrians (Arameans); location uncertain, possibly east of the Tigris. Earlier in the book (1:5), Kir is also the destination of the Syrian exile. Amos's God is the God of every exodus, including those of Israel's enemies.

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| <p>7 Are ye not as children of the Ethiopians unto me, O children of Israel? saith the LORD. Have not I brought up Israel out of the land of Egypt? and the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Syrians from Kir?</p> | <p>"Are You not as children of the Ethiopians to Me, children of Israel?" says the LORD. "Have I not brought up Israel out of the land of Egypt? And the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Syrians from Kir?"</p> |
| <p>8 Behold, the eyes of the Lord GOD are upon the sinful kingdom, and I will destroy it from off the face of the earth; saving that I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob, saith the LORD.</p> | <p>The eyes of the Lord GOD are on the sinful kingdom, and I will destroy it from off the face of the earth — saving that I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob," says the LORD.</p> |
| <p>9 For, lo, I will command, and I will sift the house of Israel among all nations, like as corn is sifted in a sieve, yet shall not the least grain fall upon the earth.</p> | <p>"For I will command, and I will sift the house of Israel among all nations, as corn is sifted in a sieve, yet not the least grain will fall on the earth.</p> |
| <p>10 All the sinners of my people shall die by the sword, which say, The evil shall not overtake nor prevent us.</p> | <p>All the sinners of My people will die by the sword — those who say, 'The evil will not overtake nor prevent us.'</p> |

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| <p>11 <i>In that day will I raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen, and close up the breaches thereof; and I will raise up his ruins, and I will build it as in the days of old:</i></p> | <p>"In that day will I raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen, and close up the breaches thereof. I will raise up his ruins, and I will build it as in the days of old,</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *The tabernacle of David* — The fallen royal house of David — his dynasty, his throne, his rule over the people of God. Amos's final word of hope: the LORD Himself will rebuild it. James quotes this verse at the Jerusalem Council in Acts 15:16–17 to prove from the OT that God always intended to call Gentiles ("the residue of men... and all the Gentiles, upon whom My name is called") into the people of God through the risen Son of David — Jesus Christ. The rebuilt tabernacle of David is the kingdom of the Messiah, into which Jews and Gentiles together are gathered.

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| <p>12 <i>That they may possess the remnant of Edom, and of all the heathen, which are called by my name, saith the LORD that doeth this.</i></p> | <p>that they may possess the remnant of Edom, and of all the heathen who are called by My name," says the LORD Who does this.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that the plowman shall overtake the reaper, and the treader of grapes him that soweth seed; and the mountains shall drop sweet wine, and all the hills shall melt.</i></p> | <p>"The days are coming," says the LORD, "when the plowman will overtake the reaper, and the treader of grapes the one who sows seed. The mountains will drop sweet wine, and all the hills will melt.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And I will bring again the captivity of my people of Israel, and they shall build the waste cities, and inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, and drink the wine thereof; they shall also make gardens, and eat the fruit of them.</i></p> | <p>I will bring again the captivity of My people Israel, and they will build the waste cities and dwell in them. They will plant vineyards and drink the wine of them. They will also make gardens, and eat the fruit of them.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And I will plant them upon their land, and they shall no more be pulled up out of their land which I have given them, saith the LORD thy God.</i></p> | <p>I will plant them on their land, and they will no more be pulled up out of their land which I have given them," says the LORD Your God.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Ps 68:21
- v2** — Ps 139:7-10; Jer 51:53
- v3** — Jer 16:16
- v5** — Amos 8:8
- v6** — Amos 5:8; Ps 104:3; Amos 4:13; Ps 104:13
- v7** — Jer 47:4; 2 Kgs 16:9; Deut 2:23
- v10** — Amos 6:3
- v11** — Acts 15:15-17; Jer 33:14-16; Isa 16:5; Jer 23:5-6; Ps 80:12
- v12** — Isa 43:7; Isa 65:1; Acts 15:17
- v13** — Joel 3:18; John 4:35; Lev 26:5; Isa 55:13; Isa 35:1-2
- v14** — Isa 61:4; Jer 30:3; Jer 30:18; Ezek 28:26; Jer 31:28
- v15** — Jer 24:6; Ezek 37:25; Isa 60:21; Ezek 34:28; Joel 3:20

Obadiah

Author: Obadiah, whose name means "servant of the LORD" or "worshipper of the LORD." Nothing certain is known about him personally. The name Obadiah appears twelve times in the Old Testament for various men, but none of them can be clearly identified with this prophet. His book and his name are all we have.

Date written: Two main views. (a) Around 845 BC, soon after the Edomite raid on Jerusalem during the reign of Jehoram (2 Chr 21:16–17); or (b) around 585 BC, soon after Edom's complicity in the Babylonian destruction of Jerusalem (Ps 137:7; Lam 4:21–22). Either way, the book is addressed in the wake of Edom's gloating betrayal of Judah.

Written to: Edom — the descendants of Esau, Jacob's twin brother, who lived in the rocky highlands southeast of the Dead Sea (the region of Petra). By extension, the book is also written to comfort Judah.

Setting: Jerusalem has been violated by foreign invaders. Edom, instead of helping their brother nation, has stood on the heights mocking — even cutting off the escape routes of fleeing Jews. Obadiah pronounces God's judgment on Edom for their pride, their violence against their brother, and their gloating in Judah's day of disaster — while declaring that Israel's God will yet have the final word: "and the kingdom shall be the LORD'S."

Where this sits historically: Most likely written c. 586 BC, just after Nebuchadnezzar's Babylonian armies destroyed Jerusalem and Edom collaborated by hunting down fleeing Judeans.

Contemporaries: Jeremiah was lamenting the fall of Jerusalem from within the ruined city, Ezekiel was already prophesying among the Babylonian exiles, and Daniel was serving in Nebuchadnezzar's court.

Big themes:

- Pride goes before destruction — Edom's mountain stronghold is no shield against God
- Kinship betrayed — the unique guilt of harming a brother
- God's judgment on the nations that harm His covenant people
- The indestructibility of God's purposes for Zion
- The eschatological day of the LORD — when the kingdoms of this world become the kingdom of our God

Key passages: Obadiah 1:3 (pride of heart); 1:10 (violence against thy brother Jacob); 1:15 (the day of the LORD); 1:17 (deliverance upon mount Zion); 1:21 (the kingdom shall be the LORD's)

How it fits: Obadiah is the shortest book in the Old Testament — only 21 verses. It is the OT's chief oracle against Edom and a primary text on the eschatological day of the LORD, when God will judge all nations and establish His kingdom. The final clause — "and the kingdom shall be the LORD'S" — anticipates the kingdom theme that runs through the rest of Scripture

and reaches its consummation in Revelation 11:15.

Chapter 1

The LORD pronounces judgment against Edom for her pride and for her violence against her brother Jacob. Though she made her nest among the stars, she will be brought down. On the day Jerusalem fell, Edom stood by, rejoiced, looted, and cut off the fugitives. The day of the LORD is near upon all the heathen, and the kingdom shall be the LORD's.

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| 1 <i>The vision of Obadiah. Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning Edom; We have heard a rumour from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent among the heathen, Arise ye, and let us rise up against her in battle.</i> | The vision of Obadiah. This is what the Lord GOD says concerning Edom. We have heard a rumour from the LORD, and an ambassador has been sent among the heathen: "Arise, and let us rise up against her in battle." |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Edom** (EE-dum) — "red" — *The nation descended from Esau (Jacob's twin brother), occupying the rocky territory southeast of the Dead Sea around Petra. Edom and Israel had a long history of hostility (Num 20:14–21; 2 Sam 8:13–14; 2 Kgs 8:20–22).*

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| 2 <i>Behold, I have made thee small among the heathen: thou art greatly despised.</i> | I have made You small among the heathen. You are greatly despised. |
| 3 <i>The pride of thine heart hath deceived thee, thou that dwellest in the clefts of the rock, whose habitation is high; that saith in his heart, Who shall bring me down to the ground?</i> | The pride of Your heart has deceived You. You live in the clefts of the rock, and Your home is on the heights. You say in Your heart, "Who shall bring me down to the ground?" |
| 4 <i>Though thou exalt thyself as the eagle, and though thou set thy nest among the stars, thence will I bring thee down, saith the LORD.</i> | Though You lift Yourself up like the eagle, and though You set Your nest among the stars, from there I will bring You down, says the LORD. |
| 5 <i>If thieves came to thee, if robbers by night, (how art thou cut off!) would they not have stolen till they had enough? if the grapegatherers came to thee, would they not leave some grapes?</i> | If thieves came to You, if robbers came by night — how You are cut off! — would they not have stolen only until they had enough? If grape gatherers came to You, would they not leave some grapes? |

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| 6 | <i>How are the things of Esau searched out! how are his hidden things sought up!</i> | How the things of Esau are searched out! How his hidden things are sought out! |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — *Esau* (EE-saw) — "hairy" — Jacob's twin brother; despised his birthright (Gen 25:29–34); the father of the Edomites.

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| 7 | <i>All the men of thy confederacy have brought thee even to the border: the men that were at peace with thee have deceived thee, and prevailed against thee; they that eat thy bread have laid a wound under thee: there is none understanding in him.</i> | All the men of your alliance have brought you to the border. The men who were at peace with you have deceived you and prevailed against you. Those who eat your bread have laid a wound under you. There is no understanding in him. |
| 8 | <i>Shall I not in that day, saith the LORD, even destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mount of Esau?</i> | In that day, says the LORD, shall I not destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mount of Esau? |
| 9 | <i>And thy mighty men, O Teman, shall be dismayed, to the end that every one of the mount of Esau may be cut off by slaughter.</i> | Your mighty men, O Teman, shall be dismayed, so that every one from the mount of Esau may be cut off by slaughter. |
| 10 | <i>For thy violence against thy brother Jacob shame shall cover thee, and thou shalt be cut off for ever.</i> | For your violence against your brother Jacob, shame shall cover you. You shall be cut off forever. |
| 11 | <i>In the day that thou stoodest on the other side, in the day that the strangers carried away captive his forces, and foreigners entered into his gates, and cast lots upon Jerusalem, even thou wast as one of them.</i> | On the day you stood on the other side — when strangers carried away his forces as captives, and foreigners entered his gates and cast lots for Jerusalem — you were like one of them. |

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| 12 <i>But thou shouldest not have looked on the day of thy brother in the day that he became a stranger; neither shouldest thou have rejoiced over the children of Judah in the day of their destruction; neither shouldest thou have spoken proudly in the day of distress.</i> | But you should not have looked on the day of your brother in the day that he became a stranger. You should not have rejoiced over the children of Judah in the day of their destruction. You should not have spoken proudly in the day of distress. |
| 13 <i>Thou shouldest not have entered into the gate of my people in the day of their calamity; yea, thou shouldest not have looked on their affliction in the day of their calamity, nor have laid hands on their substance in the day of their calamity;</i> | You should not have entered into the gate of My people in the day of their calamity. You should not have looked on their affliction in the day of their calamity, nor laid hands on their goods in the day of their calamity. |
| 14 <i>Neither shouldest thou have stood in the crossway, to cut off those of his that did escape; neither shouldest thou have delivered up those of his that did remain in the day of distress.</i> | You should not have stood at the crossway to cut off those of his who escaped. You should not have handed over those of his who remained in the day of distress. |
| 15 <i>For the day of the LORD is near upon all the heathen: as thou hast done, it shall be done unto thee: thy reward shall return upon thine own head.</i> | For the day of the LORD is near on all the heathen. As you have done, it shall be done to You. Your reward shall return on Your own head. |
| 16 <i>For as ye have drunk upon my holy mountain, so shall all the heathen drink continually, yea, they shall drink, and they shall swallow down, and they shall be as though they had not been.</i> | For as You have drunk on My holy mountain, so shall all the heathen drink continually. They shall drink, and they shall swallow down, and they shall be as though they had not been. |
| 17 <i>But upon mount Zion shall be deliverance, and there shall be holiness; and the house of Jacob shall possess their possessions.</i> | But on mount Zion shall be deliverance, and there shall be holiness; and the house of Jacob shall possess their possessions. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mount Zion** (ZY-on) — *The Temple Mount in Jerusalem; in prophecy the seat of God's covenant kingdom; the dwelling place of the LORD.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jacob** (JAY-kub) — *"supplanter" — Esau's twin; the father of the twelve tribes of Israel; renamed Israel by God (Gen 32:28). "The house of Jacob" = Israel.*

- 18 *And the house of Jacob shall be a fire, and the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau for stubble, and they shall kindle in them, and devour them; and there shall not be any remaining of the house of Esau; for the LORD hath spoken it.* The house of Jacob shall be a fire, and the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau shall be stubble. They shall kindle in them and devour them, and there shall not be any remaining of the house of Esau. For the LORD has spoken it.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joseph** (JO-suff) — *"may God add" — Jacob's eleventh son; sold into Egypt by his brothers; rose to be Pharaoh's second-in-command; saved his family in famine. "The house of Joseph" = the northern tribes (Ephraim and Manasseh).*

- 19 *And they of the south shall possess the mount of Esau; and they of the plain the Philistines: and they shall possess the fields of Ephraim, and the fields of Samaria: and Benjamin shall possess Gilead.* Those of the south shall possess the mount of Esau, and those of the plain shall possess the Philistines. They shall possess the fields of Ephraim and the fields of Samaria, and Benjamin shall possess Gilead.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **the south** — *KJV consistently renders the Hebrew negeb as "the south" — a direction, not a transliterated place name. Modern translations often print "the Negev," but the KJV reading treats it as the southern region of Judah. The modern column preserves "the south."*

- 20 *And the captivity of this host of the children of Israel shall possess that of the Canaanites, even unto Zarephath; and the captivity of Jerusalem, which is in Sepharad, shall possess the cities of the south.* The captivity of this host of the children of Israel shall possess that of the Canaanites, as far as Zarephath. The captivity of Jerusalem, which is in Sepharad, shall possess the cities of the south.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sepharad** (SEP-ah-rad) — *Location uncertain — possibly Sardis in Asia Minor, or a region of Media; named here as the place of certain Israelite exiles.*

- 21 *And saviours shall come up on mount Zion to judge the mount of Esau; and the kingdom shall be the LORD's.* And saviours shall come up on mount Zion to judge the mount of Esau; and the kingdom shall be the LORD's.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Saviours** (SAYV-yurs) — KJV term for God-raised deliverers — leaders He uses to rescue His people and bring His justice. Modern translations often say "deliverers," but the KJV word points to the same Hebrew root from which we get the name Yeshua / Jesus. The final Saviour of mount Zion is Christ Himself, and through Him the kingdom belongs forever to the LORD.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Amos 1:11-12; Joel 3:19; Mal 1:3-4; Ezek 25:12-14; Ezek 35:3-15
v3 — Isa 14:13-15; Prov 29:23; Jer 49:16; Isa 16:6
v4 — Amos 9:2; Isa 14:12-15; Job 20:6-7; Hab 2:9; Jer 51:53
v9 — Ezek 25:13; Amos 1:12; Isa 63:1-3
v10 — Amos 1:11; Mal 1:3-4; Gen 27:41
v11 — Ps 137:7; Nah 3:10
v12 — Mic 4:11; Prov 17:5; Ezek 35:15; 1 Sam 2:3; Matt 27:40-43
v15 — Jas 2:13; Hab 2:8; Ezek 30:3; Matt 7:2; Mic 5:15
v17 — Rev 21:27; Amos 9:11-15; Isa 14:1-2; Joel 3:19-21; Amos 9:8
v18 — Zech 12:6; Isa 10:17
v20 — 1 Kgs 17:9-10; Luke 4:26
v21 — Zech 14:9; Jas 5:20; Dan 7:27; Rev 11:15

Jonah

Author: *Jonah son of Amittai — the same prophet named in 2 Kings 14:25 who prophesied during the reign of Jeroboam II of Israel (c. 793–753 BC). He was a native of Gath-hepher in Galilee, in the tribe of Zebulun.*

Date written: *8th century BC. The events probably took place c. 780–760 BC, at the height of Assyria's cruelty against the surrounding nations.*

Written to: *A Hebrew audience. The book is a narrative about the prophet, not a sermon to Nineveh — Israel reads over Jonah's shoulder and sees its own heart.*

Setting: *The LORD commands Jonah to go to Nineveh — the capital of Assyria, the empire then threatening Israel — and cry against it for its wickedness. Jonah refuses. He boards a ship sailing the opposite direction, toward Tarshish (likely southern Spain — the far western edge of the known world). A great storm threatens the ship; Jonah confesses; the sailors throw him overboard at his own request; the LORD prepares a great fish to swallow him; Jonah prays from inside the fish's belly. After three days and three nights the fish vomits him onto dry land. The LORD's word comes a second time; this time Jonah obeys; the entire city of Nineveh repents in sackcloth and ashes; the LORD spares them. Jonah is furious. The book closes with God's gentle rebuke of His sulking prophet under a withered gourd.*

Where this sits historically: *The events fall c. 780–760 BC during the reign of Jeroboam II of Israel and the Assyrian king Ashur-dan III, when Nineveh was the dominant metropolis of the ancient Near East.*

Contemporaries: *Elisha had recently died, Amos and Hosea would begin prophesying in the north within a generation, and Uzziah was reigning over Judah.*

Big themes:

- *The universal scope of God's mercy — reaching even to the worst of pagan empires*
- *The LORD's absolute sovereignty over the sea, the great fish, the gourd, the worm, and the east wind*
- *The resistance of the human heart to God's mercy toward those we hate*
- *Jonah as a type of Christ — three days and three nights in the fish picturing Christ's death and resurrection (Matt 12:39–40)*
- *The LORD's compassion on those who do not know their right hand from their left*
- *The failure of even a called prophet to share his Master's heart*

Key passages: *Jonah 1:1–3 (the call and the flight); 1:17 (the great fish); 2:9 ("Salvation is of the LORD"); 3:4–10 (the repentance of Nineveh); 4:2 (Jonah's complaint); 4:11 (the LORD's final question)*

How it fits: *Jonah is the most narratively unique of the Minor Prophets — a story about a prophet rather than a collection of his oracles. Jesus cites Jonah as a sign of His own death and resurrection (Matt 12:39–40; 16:4) and as a witness against the impenitent (Matt 12:41;*

Luke 11:32). The book is the OT's clearest picture of God's mercy reaching beyond Israel to the Gentiles — anticipating the gospel going to all nations. It is also the OT's most pointed exposure of the contradiction in the human heart when our preferences conflict with God's mercy.

Chapter 1

Jonah fled from the LORD's command to preach to Nineveh and boarded a ship to Tarshish. A great storm struck, the sailors cast lots, and the lot fell on Jonah. At his own word they threw him into the sea, and the storm ceased. The LORD prepared a great fish to swallow Jonah, and he was in its belly three days and three nights.

1 Now the word of the LORD came unto Now the word of the LORD came to
Jonah the son of Amittai, saying, Jonah the son of Amittai, saying,

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jonah** (JOH-nuh) — "dove" — A Hebrew prophet during the reign of Jeroboam II of Israel (8th century BC); a native of Gath-hepher in Galilee (2 Kgs 14:25; Josh 19:13). The LORD sent him to preach to Nineveh, the capital of Assyria — Israel's greatest enemy. His story is the OT's clearest single picture of God's mercy reaching to the Gentiles.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amittai** (uh-MIT-eye) — "truthful, faithful" — Jonah's father. Named only here and in 2 Kings 14:25.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gath-hepher** (GATH-HEE-fer) — Jonah's hometown (2 Kgs 14:25); a Galilean village in the tribe of Zebulun, a few miles north of Nazareth.

2 Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, "Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city,
and cry against it; for their and cry against it; for their wickedness
wickedness is come up before me. is come up before Me."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nineveh** (NIN-eh-veh) — Capital of the Assyrian Empire, on the east bank of the Tigris River (across from modern Mosul, Iraq). One of the largest cities of the ancient world — "an exceeding great city of three days' journey" (Jonah 3:3). The Assyrians were notorious for their cruelty in warfare.

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| <p>3 <i>But Jonah rose up to flee unto Tarshish from the presence of the LORD, and went down to Joppa; and he found a ship going to Tarshish: so he paid the fare thereof, and went down into it, to go with them unto Tarshish from the presence of the LORD.</i></p> | <p>But Jonah rose up to flee to Tarshish, away from the presence of the LORD. He went down to Joppa and found a ship going to Tarshish. So He paid the fare and went down into it, to go with them to Tarshish, away from the presence of the LORD.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tarshish** (TAR-shish) — A distant western port, almost certainly Tartessos in southern Spain. For a man fleeing an east-bound errand to Nineveh, Tarshish was "the ends of the earth" in the opposite direction.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joppa** (JOP-uh) — Ancient port on the Mediterranean coast (modern Jaffa, part of Tel Aviv); the natural harbor for any sea voyage out of Israel. Also where Peter received the vision of the great sheet (Acts 10).

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| <p>4 <i>But the LORD sent out a great wind into the sea, and there was a mighty tempest in the sea, so that the ship was like to be broken.</i></p> | <p>But the LORD sent out a great wind on the sea, and there was a mighty storm at sea, so that the ship was about to be broken apart.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Then the mariners were afraid, and cried every man unto his god, and cast forth the wares that were in the ship into the sea, to lighten it of them. But Jonah was gone down into the sides of the ship; and he lay, and was fast asleep.</i></p> | <p>Then the sailors were afraid, and every man cried out to his own god. They threw the cargo of the ship into the sea to lighten it. But Jonah had gone down into the inner part of the ship; and He lay there fast asleep.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>So the shipmaster came to him, and said unto him, What meanest thou, O sleeper? arise, call upon thy God, if so be that God will think upon us, that we perish not.</i></p> | <p>So the shipmaster came to Him and said, "What do You mean, O sleeper? Arise, call on Your God. Perhaps God will think on us, so that we do not perish."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And they said every one to his fellow, Come, and let us cast lots, that we may know for whose cause this evil is upon us. So they cast lots, and the lot fell upon Jonah.</i></p> | <p>And they said to one another, "Come, let us cast lots, so that we may know on whose account this trouble has come on us." So they cast lots, and the lot fell on Jonah.</p> |

- 8 *Then said they unto him, Tell us, we pray thee, for whose cause this evil is upon us; What is thine occupation? and whence comest thou? what is thy country? and of what people art thou?* Then they said to him, "Please tell us — on whose account has this trouble come on us? What is your occupation? Where do you come from? What is your country? And of what people are you?"
- 9 *And he said unto them, I am an Hebrew; and I fear the LORD, the God of heaven, which hath made the sea and the dry land.* And He said to them, "I am a Hebrew, and I fear the LORD, the God of heaven, who made the sea and the dry land."
- 10 *Then were the men exceedingly afraid, and said unto him, Why hast thou done this? For the men knew that he fled from the presence of the LORD, because he had told them.* Then the men were greatly afraid and said to Him, "Why have You done this?" For the men knew that He was fleeing from the presence of the LORD, because He had told them.
- 11 *Then said they unto him, What shall we do unto thee, that the sea may be calm unto us? for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous.* Then they said to Him, "What shall we do to You, so that the sea may be calm for us?" — for the sea grew more and more stormy.
- 12 *And he said unto them, Take me up, and cast me forth into the sea; so shall the sea be calm unto you: for I know that for my sake this great tempest is upon you.* And He said to them, "Take me up and cast me into the sea, and the sea will be calm for You. For I know that this great storm is on You on my account."
- 13 *Nevertheless the men rowed hard to bring it to the land; but they could not: for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous against them.* Nevertheless the men rowed hard to bring the ship back to land; but they could not, for the sea grew more and more stormy against them.
- 14 *Wherefore they cried unto the LORD, and said, We beseech thee, O LORD, we beseech thee, let us not perish for this man's life, and lay not upon us innocent blood: for thou, O LORD, hast done as it pleased thee.* Therefore they cried out to the LORD and said, "We beg You, O LORD, we beg You, do not let us perish for this man's life. Do not lay innocent blood on us, for You, O LORD, have done as it pleased You."

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| <p>15 <i>So they took up Jonah, and cast him forth into the sea: and the sea ceased from her raging.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Then the men feared the LORD exceedingly, and offered a sacrifice unto the LORD, and made vows.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Now the LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.</i></p> | <p>So they took Jonah up and cast him into the sea; and the sea ceased from its raging.</p> <p>Then the men greatly feared the LORD. They offered a sacrifice to the LORD and made vows.</p> <p>Now the LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 11:32; Luke 11:29-30; 2 Kgs 14:25; Matt 16:4; Matt 12:39-41
- v2 — Gen 18:20-21; Gen 10:11; Nah 1:1; Isa 58:1; Zeph 2:13-15
- v3 — Ps 139:7-12; Josh 19:46; Gen 4:16; Acts 9:43; 2 Thess 1:9
- v4 — Ps 107:23-31; Matt 8:24-27
- v6 — Jonah 3:9; Ps 107:28-29; 2 Sam 12:22; Eph 5:14; Mark 4:37-41
- v7 — Prov 16:33; Josh 7:13-18
- v8 — Gen 47:3; 1 Sam 30:13; Josh 7:19; Jas 5:16; 1 Sam 14:43
- v9 — Ps 146:5-6; Neh 9:6; Ps 136:26; Ps 95:5-6
- v12 — 2 Sam 24:17; Josh 7:12; 1 Chr 21:17
- v14 — Ps 115:3; Ps 135:6; Deut 21:8; Eph 1:11
- v16 — Ps 116:14; Dan 6:26; Ps 107:22; Ps 50:14; Gen 8:20
- v17 — Matt 12:40; Luke 11:30; Matt 16:4; Ps 104:25-26

Chapter 2

From inside the belly of the great fish, Jonah prayed to the LORD. He cried out from the depths of the sea, and the LORD heard him. Jonah declared, "Salvation is of the LORD." The LORD spoke to the fish, and it vomited Jonah onto dry land.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Jonah prayed unto the LORD his God out of the fish's belly,</i></p> <p>2 <i>And said, I cried by reason of mine affliction unto the LORD, and he heard me; out of the belly of hell cried I, and thou heardest my voice.</i></p> | <p>Then Jonah prayed to the LORD His God out of the fish's belly,</p> <p>and said, "I cried out to the LORD because of my affliction, and He heard me. Out of the belly of hell I cried, and You heard my voice.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — *The place of the dead and of God's judgment. KJV uses one word — "hell" — for the Hebrew Sheol and the Greek Hades and Gehenna. Modern translations often substitute "Sheol," "the grave," or "the depths" — but the KJV preserves the single word "hell." Here Jonah is using it figuratively: from the depths of dying, as good as in the grave, he cried out and the LORD heard him.*

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| 3 | <i>For thou hadst cast me into the deep, in the midst of the seas; and the floods compassed me about: all thy billows and thy waves passed over me.</i> | For You had cast me into the deep, into the midst of the seas; and the floods surrounded me. All Your billows and Your waves passed over me. |
| 4 | <i>Then I said, I am cast out of thy sight; yet I will look again toward thy holy temple.</i> | Then I said, 'I am cast out of Your sight — yet I will look again toward Your holy temple.' |
| 5 | <i>The waters compassed me about, even to the soul: the depth closed me round about, the weeds were wrapped about my head.</i> | The waters surrounded me, even to the soul; the deep closed in around me; the weeds were wrapped about my head. |
| 6 | <i>I went down to the bottoms of the mountains; the earth with her bars was about me for ever: yet hast thou brought up my life from corruption, O LORD my God.</i> | I went down to the bottoms of the mountains; the earth with its bars closed in on me forever. Yet You have brought up my life from corruption, O LORD my God. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Corruption** (kuh-RUP-shun) — *Decay; the grave; the rotting that begins after death. KJV "brought up my life from corruption" means: You rescued me from the pit where my body would have rotted. Some modern translations say "the pit" — KJV keeps the stronger word.*

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| 7 | <i>When my soul fainted within me I remembered the LORD: and my prayer came in unto thee, into thine holy temple.</i> | When my soul fainted within me, I remembered the LORD; and my prayer came to You, into Your holy temple. |
| 8 | <i>They that observe lying vanities forsake their own mercy.</i> | Those who hold to lying vanities forsake their own mercy. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Lying vanities** (LYE-ing VAN-ih-teez) — *KJV idiom for worthless idols. A "vanity" in KJV is something empty, hollow, with no real substance; "lying vanities" are the false gods that promise what they cannot deliver. Those who cling to them turn away from the only real Mercy there is.*

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| <p>9 <i>But I will sacrifice unto thee with the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay that that I have vowed. Salvation is of the LORD.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And the LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.</i></p> | <p>But I will sacrifice to You with the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay what I have vowed. Salvation is of the LORD."</p> <p>And the LORD spoke to the fish, and it vomited Jonah out on the dry land.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lam 3:53-56; Ps 130:1-2; Ps 91:15; Job 13:15; Isa 26:16
v2 — Ps 18:4-6; Ps 120:1; Ps 34:6; Ps 86:13; Ps 88:1-7
v3 — Ps 42:7; Lam 3:54; Ps 69:1-2
v4 — Ps 31:22; Ps 5:7; 2 Chr 6:38; Isa 38:17
v5 — Ps 69:1-2; Lam 3:54
v6 — Ps 30:3; Ps 16:10
v7 — Ps 18:6; 2 Chr 30:27; 1 Sam 30:6; Ps 143:5; Ps 11:4
v8 — Ps 31:6; 2 Kgs 17:15; Jer 2:13; 1 Sam 12:21; Jer 10:8
v9 — Ps 3:8; Ps 50:14; Eccl 5:4-5; Heb 13:15; Ps 50:23
v10 — Matt 8:26-27; Ps 33:9; Isa 50:2; Matt 8:8-9; Gen 1:3

Chapter 3

The word of the LORD came to Jonah a second time: "Go to Nineveh." Jonah obeyed and preached, "Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown." The entire city believed God — from the king to the least of them — and put on sackcloth and fasted. God saw their repentance and relented from the disaster.

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| <p>1 <i>And the word of the LORD came unto Jonah the second time, saying,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Arise, go unto Nineveh, that great city, and preach unto it the preaching that I bid thee.</i></p> <p>3 <i>So Jonah arose, and went unto Nineveh, according to the word of the LORD. Now Nineveh was an exceeding great city of three days' journey.</i></p> | <p>And the word of the LORD came to Jonah the second time, saying,</p> <p>"Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and preach to it the preaching that I bid You."</p> <p>So Jonah arose and went to Nineveh, according to the word of the LORD. Now Nineveh was an exceedingly great city, three days' journey across.</p> |
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| 4 | <i>And Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried, and said, Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown.</i> | And Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and He cried out and said, "Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown!" |
| 5 | <i>So the people of Nineveh believed God, and proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest of them even to the least of them.</i> | So the people of Nineveh believed God. They proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest of them even to the least of them. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sackcloth** (SAK-kloth) — A coarse, rough cloth — usually of goat's hair — worn next to the skin as a sign of mourning, repentance, or grief. To put on sackcloth was to publicly humble oneself before God.

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| 6 | <i>For word came unto the king of Nineveh, and he arose from his throne, and he laid his robe from him, and covered him with sackcloth, and sat in ashes.</i> | For word came to the king of Nineveh, and he arose from his throne. He laid aside his robe, covered himself with sackcloth, and sat in ashes. |
| 7 | <i>And he caused it to be proclaimed and published through Nineveh by the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, Let neither man nor beast, herd nor flock, taste any thing: let them not feed, nor drink water:</i> | And he had it proclaimed and published throughout Nineveh, by the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, "Let neither man nor beast, herd nor flock, taste anything. Let them not feed, nor drink water. |
| 8 | <i>But let man and beast be covered with sackcloth, and cry mightily unto God: yea, let them turn every one from his evil way, and from the violence that is in their hands.</i> | But let man and beast be covered with sackcloth, and cry mightily to God. Let every one turn from his evil way, and from the violence that is in their hands. |
| 9 | <i>Who can tell if God will turn and repent, and turn away from his fierce anger, that we perish not?</i> | Who can tell if God will turn and repent, and turn away from His fierce anger, so that we do not perish?" |
| 10 | <i>And God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way; and God repented of the evil, that he had said that he would do unto them; and he did it not.</i> | And God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way; and God repented of the disaster that He had said He would do to them, and He did it not. |

Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

v2 — Jer 1:17; Ezek 2:7

v4 — Deut 18:22; Jer 18:7-10

v5 — Luke 11:32; Dan 9:3; Matt 12:41; Joel 2:12-17; Joel 1:14

v6 — Jas 4:6-10; Esth 4:1-4

v7 — 2 Chr 20:3; Joel 2:15-16; Jonah 3:5; Joel 1:18

v9 — 2 Sam 12:22; Joel 2:13-14

v10 — Jer 18:8; 1 Kgs 21:27-29; Ex 32:14; Luke 11:32; Amos 7:6

Chapter 4

Jonah was furious that the LORD spared Nineveh and admitted he fled precisely because he knew God was gracious and merciful, longsuffering and abundant in mercy. The LORD prepared a gourd for shade, then a worm to destroy it and a scorching east wind. He rebuked Jonah: "You pity the gourd — should I not pity Nineveh, with more than 120,000 persons who cannot tell their right hand from their left?"

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| <p>1 But it displeased Jonah exceedingly, and he was very angry.</p> | <p>But it displeased Jonah greatly, and he was very angry.</p> |
| <p>2 And he prayed unto the LORD, and said, I pray thee, O LORD, was not this my saying, when I was yet in my country? Therefore I fled before unto Tarshish: for I knew that thou art a gracious God, and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and repentest thee of the evil.</p> | <p>And He prayed to the LORD and said, "I pray You, O LORD — was this not what I said when I was still in my own country? That is why I fled beforehand to Tarshish. For I knew that You are a gracious God, and merciful, longsuffering, and of great kindness, and One who repents of the evil.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suff-er-ing) — Patient with people who are difficult; slow to grow angry. KJV's distinctive rendering of the Hebrew "slow to anger." It pictures God bearing long with sinners — giving them time to repent, as He did with Nineveh. The same word describes God's patience with us (2 Pet 3:9).

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| <p>3 Therefore now, O LORD, take, I beseech thee, my life from me; for it is better for me to die than to live.</p> | <p>Therefore now, O LORD, I beg You, take my life from me; for it is better for me to die than to live."</p> |
| <p>4 Then said the LORD, Doest thou well to be angry?</p> | <p>Then the LORD said, "Do You do well to be angry?"</p> |

- 5 *So Jonah went out of the city, and sat on the east side of the city, and there made him a booth, and sat under it in the shadow, till he might see what would become of the city.* So Jonah went out of the city and sat on the east side of the city. There He made Himself a booth and sat under it in the shade, until He might see what would become of the city.
- 6 *And the LORD God prepared a gourd, and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shadow over his head, to deliver him from his grief. So Jonah was exceeding glad of the gourd.* And the LORD God prepared a gourd and made it grow up over Jonah, so that it might be a shade over his head, to deliver Him from His discomfort. So Jonah was very glad of the gourd.

■ **WORD NOTE — Gourd (GORD)** — *A fast-growing leafy plant — probably the castor-oil plant or a kind of vine — with broad leaves that throw a wide shade. The point is not the species but that the LORD "prepared" it, just as He prepared the great fish, the worm, and the east wind. The whole book turns on what the LORD prepares.*

- 7 *But God prepared a worm when the morning rose the next day, and it smote the root of the gourd that it withered.* But God prepared a worm when the morning rose the next day, and it struck the gourd so that it withered.
- 8 *And it came to pass, when the sun did arise, that God prepared a vehement east wind; and the sun beat upon the head of Jonah, that he fainted, and wished in himself to die, and said, It is better for me to die than to live.* And when the sun arose, God prepared a fierce east wind. The sun beat on the head of Jonah, so that he fainted. And he wished within himself to die, and said, "It is better for me to die than to live."

■ **WORD NOTE — East wind (EEST WIND)** — *In the geography of Israel, the east wind blew off the desert: hot, dry, and scorching — what we would call a sirocco. KJV calls it "vehement" — fierce, violent. It is the LORD's fourth and final "prepared" instrument in the book.*

- 9 *And God said to Jonah, Doest thou well to be angry for the gourd? And he said, I do well to be angry, even unto death.* And God said to Jonah, "Do you do well to be angry over the gourd?" And He said, "I do well to be angry, even to death."

- 10 *Then said the LORD, Thou hast had pity on the gourd, for the which thou hast not laboured, neither madest it grow; which came up in a night, and perished in a night:* Then the LORD said, "You have had pity on the gourd, for which You did not labor, nor make it grow; which came up in a night and perished in a night.
- 11 *And should not I spare Nineveh, that great city, wherein are more than sixscore thousand persons that cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand; and also much cattle?* And should I not spare Nineveh, that great city, in which there are more than sixscore thousand persons that cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand — and also much cattle?"
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Luke 15:28; Jonah 4:9; Matt 20:15
v2 — Ps 86:15; Ex 34:6-7; Num 14:18-19; Joel 2:13-14; Ps 145:8
v3 — 1 Kgs 19:4; Eccl 7:1; Num 11:15; Jer 20:14-18; Num 20:3
v4 — Matt 20:15; Jonah 4:9
v7 — Joel 1:12
v8 — Jonah 4:3; Ps 121:6
v11 — Matt 18:33; Luke 15:28-32; Ps 145:8-9; Jonah 1:2; Ps 36:6

Micah

Author: Micah the Morasthite — his name means "who is like the LORD?" A contemporary of Isaiah, Micah came from Moresheth-gath in the Shephelah, the foothills of Judah southwest of Jerusalem. He was a country prophet rather than a court prophet — a man of the villages who knew the bite of corrupt judges, dishonest merchants, and grasping landowners firsthand.

Date written: c. 735–700 BC, during the reigns of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah of Judah (1:1). His ministry spans the fall of the northern kingdom (722 BC) and the Assyrian invasion of Judah under Sennacherib (701 BC).

Written to: Both kingdoms — "Hear, all ye people" (1:2). The book addresses both Samaria, the capital of the northern kingdom of Israel, and Jerusalem, the capital of the southern kingdom of Judah.

Setting: Assyria is rising. The northern kingdom is in its final years and will fall to Sargon II in 722 BC. Judah is corrupt: princes who hate good and love evil, prophets who divine for money, priests who teach for hire, judges who take bribes, rich men full of violence, merchants with false balances, idolatry on the high places. Micah preaches judgment on both kingdoms — and then comfort: the LORD will gather a remnant; a ruler will come forth from Bethlehem Ephrathah whose goings forth are from everlasting; the mountain of the LORD's house will be established above the hills, and all nations shall flow to it.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 735–700 BC under Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah of Judah, through the Assyrian destruction of Samaria (722 BC) and Sennacherib's invasion of Judah (701 BC).

Contemporaries: Isaiah ministered in Jerusalem alongside Micah, while Hosea was still active in the dying northern kingdom and the Assyrian kings Tiglath-Pileser III, Shalmaneser V, Sargon II, and Sennacherib ruled in sequence.

Big themes:

- Judgment on the corrupt leaders of both Samaria and Jerusalem
- The social sins of injustice, oppression, false weights, and violence
- The future glory of the mountain of the LORD's house and the universal reign of peace
- The Messiah from Bethlehem whose origins are from everlasting (5:2)
- What the LORD requires (6:8 — do justly, love mercy, walk humbly)
- The LORD's incomparable mercy in pardoning iniquity and casting sins into the depths of the sea (7:18–20)
- The truth of God's covenant promises to Abraham and Jacob (7:20)

Key passages: Micah 4:1–3 (the mountain of the LORD's house); 5:2 (Bethlehem the birthplace of the Messiah); 6:6–8 (what doth the LORD require); 7:18–20 (Who is a God like unto thee).

How it fits: Micah is the Old Testament's clearest single prediction of the Messiah's birthplace — Bethlehem Ephrathah — quoted by the chief priests in Matthew 2:6 when Herod asked where the Christ should be born. Micah 6:8 — "do justly, love mercy, walk humbly with thy God" — is among the most quoted ethical passages in all of Scripture. With Isaiah, his contemporary, Micah is the major prophet of the 8th-century BC Assyrian crisis as it bore on Judah. He sees the storm coming, names the sins that brought it, and points past the storm to the Ruler from Bethlehem and to the God who delights in mercy.

Chapter 1

The LORD comes down from His holy temple to tread upon the high places of the earth. Samaria will be made a heap of rubble — her images beaten to pieces and her idols burned. The wound is incurable and reaches to the gate of Jerusalem itself. Micah mourns for the cities of Judah one by one.

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The word of the LORD that came to Micah the Morasthite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.
- The word of the LORD that came to Micah the Morasthite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah — the word he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Micah** (MY-kuh) — "Who is like the LORD?" — A prophet from Moresheth-gath in the Shephelah of Judah, a contemporary of Isaiah. He prophesied during the 8th century BC, warning of judgment on both Israel and Judah while also foretelling the birth of the Messiah in Bethlehem. He is called "the Morasthite" — that is, the man from Moresheth.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Moresheth** (MOR-eh-sheth) — Also called Moresheth-gath (1:14) — Micah's hometown, a small village in the Shephelah (the foothills of Judah) about twenty-five miles southwest of Jerusalem, near Gath and Lachish. Micah was a country prophet from a country town.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Samaria** (suh-MAIR-ee-uh) — The capital city of the northern kingdom of Israel, built by King Omri on a hill he bought from Shemer (1 Kings 16:24). It stands here for the whole northern kingdom — the ten tribes — which fell to Assyria in 722 BC.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jerusalem** (juh-ROO-suh-lem) — "city of peace" — The capital of the southern kingdom of Judah, the city of David, the place of the temple. It stands here for the whole southern kingdom — Judah and Benjamin.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah** — Three successive kings of Judah whose reigns span Micah's ministry (c. 750–686 BC). Jotham was a good king; Ahaz was wicked and brought idolatry into Jerusalem; Hezekiah was a great reformer whose prayer turned away the Assyrian invasion of 701 BC (2 Kings 18–20; Isaiah 36–39).

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| <p>2 <i>Hear, all ye people; hearken, O earth, and all that therein is: and let the Lord GOD be witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For, behold, the LORD cometh forth out of his place, and will come down, and tread upon the high places of the earth.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And the mountains shall be molten under him, and the valleys shall be cleft, as wax before the fire, and as the waters that are poured down a steep place.</i></p> <p>5 <i>For the transgression of Jacob is all this, and for the sins of the house of Israel. What is the transgression of Jacob? is it not Samaria? and what are the high places of Judah? are they not Jerusalem?</i></p> | <p>Hear, all You peoples. Listen, O earth, and everything in it. Let the Lord GOD be a witness against you — the Lord from His holy temple.</p> <p>For the LORD comes forth out of His place. He will come down and tread on the high places of the earth.</p> <p>The mountains will melt beneath Him, and the valleys will split apart — like wax before the fire, like waters poured down a steep slope.</p> <p>All this is for the transgression of Jacob and for the sins of the house of Israel. What is the transgression of Jacob? Is it not Samaria? And what are the high places of Judah? Are they not Jerusalem?</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jacob** (JAY-kub) — "supplanter, heel-grabber" — The son of Isaac, grandson of Abraham. God renamed him Israel (Genesis 32:28). "Jacob" here stands for the whole covenant people descended from him — both kingdoms together.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — Crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. Transgression is the open, deliberate stepping over of God's law — sin as rebellion, not just as mistake.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — Deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. Where "transgression" is crossing the line, "iniquity" is the crooked, bent quality of a heart turned away from God.

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| <p>6 <i>Therefore I will make Samaria as an heap of the field, and as plantings of a vineyard: and I will pour down the stones thereof into the valley, and I will discover the foundations thereof.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I will make Samaria a heap of ruins in the open field, a place for planting a vineyard. I will pour down her stones into the valley, and I will lay bare her foundations.</p> |
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- 7 *And all the graven images thereof shall be beaten to pieces, and all the hires thereof shall be burned with the fire, and all the idols thereof will I lay desolate: for she gathered it of the hire of an harlot, and they shall return to the hire of an harlot.* All her carved images will be beaten to pieces, and all her wages will be burned with fire. I will lay all her idols desolate, for she gathered them from the wages of a harlot, and to the wages of a harlot they will return.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Heathen** (HEE-thun) — *The nations outside Israel's covenant with God — the Gentiles in their idolatry and ignorance of the true God. KJV uses "heathen" throughout the prophets for these pagan peoples.*

- 8 *Therefore I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls.* Therefore I will wail and howl. I will go stripped and naked. I will make a wailing like the dragons and a mourning like the owls.
- 9 *For her wound is incurable; for it is come unto Judah; he is come unto the gate of my people, even to Jerusalem.* For her wound is incurable, and it has come even to Judah. It has reached the gate of my people, even to Jerusalem.
- 10 *Declare ye it not at Gath, weep ye not at all: in the house of Aphrah roll thyself in the dust.* Tell it not in Gath. Weep not at all. In the house of Aphrah, roll yourself in the dust.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gath** (GATH) — *One of the five chief cities of the Philistines, the hometown of the giant Goliath. Micah's home village of Moresheth was nearby — "Moresheth-gath" means "Moresheth near Gath." "Tell it not in Gath" echoes David's lament for Saul (2 Samuel 1:20): do not let the enemies of God's people rejoice.*

- 11 *Pass ye away, thou inhabitant of Saphir, having thy shame naked: the inhabitant of Zaanen came not forth in the mourning of Beth-ezel; he shall receive of you his standing.* Pass on your way, you who live in Saphir, in shameful nakedness. The one who lives in Zaanen does not come out. The mourning of Beth-ezel will take from you its place to stand.
- 12 *For the inhabitant of Maroth waited carefully for good: but evil came down from the LORD unto the gate of Jerusalem.* For the one who lives in Maroth waited anxiously for good — but evil came down from the LORD to the gate of Jerusalem.

- 13 *O thou inhabitant of Lachish, bind the chariot to the swift beast: she is the beginning of the sin to the daughter of Zion: for the transgressions of Israel were found in thee.* You who live in Lachish, harness the chariot to the swift horse. She was the beginning of sin to the daughter of Zion, for the transgressions of Israel were found in You.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lachish** (LAY-kish) — A major fortified city in the Shephelah of Judah, second only to Jerusalem in importance. Sennacherib of Assyria besieged and captured Lachish in 701 BC — a campaign he commemorated in carved reliefs in his palace at Nineveh. Micah says the sins of the northern kingdom had taken root here first.

- 14 *Therefore shalt thou give presents to Moresheth-gath: the houses of Achzib shall be a lie to the kings of Israel.* Therefore You will give parting gifts to Moresheth-gath. The houses of Achzib will be a deception to the kings of Israel.
- 15 *Yet will I bring an heir unto thee, O inhabitant of Mareshah: he shall come unto Adullam the glory of Israel.* I will yet bring an heir to You, O inhabitant of Mareshah. The glory of Israel will come to Adullam.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Adullam** (uh-DUL-am) — A town in the Shephelah of Judah, famous for the cave where David hid from Saul and gathered his band of outcasts (1 Samuel 22:1). "The glory of Israel will come to Adullam" — that is, the leaders of the land will flee to caves and hiding places, as David once did.

- 16 *Make thee bald, and poll thee for thy delicate children; enlarge thy baldness as the eagle; for they are gone into captivity from thee.* Make Yourself bald and shave Your head for the children You delight in. Make Your baldness as wide as the eagle's, for they have gone from You into captivity.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 26:18; Isa 1:1; Hos 1:1
 v2 — Ps 11:4; Isa 1:2
 v3 — Amos 4:13; Isa 26:21
 v4 — Nah 1:5; Ps 97:5
 v5 — Jer 2:19; Amos 8:14
 v6 — Ezek 13:14
 v7 — Deut 23:18
 v10 — 2 Sam 1:20

v12 — Jer 14:19

v14 — Josh 15:44

v16 — Isa 22:12

Chapter 2

Woe to those who lie awake plotting wickedness and seize fields and houses by violence. The LORD plans disaster against this family of oppressors. False prophets tell the people what they want to hear, but the LORD will gather the remnant of Israel like sheep in a fold, and their king will pass through before them with the LORD at their head.

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| 1 | <i>Woe to them that devise iniquity, and work evil upon their beds! when the morning is light, they practise it, because it is in the power of their hand.</i> | Woe to those who devise iniquity and plot evil on their beds! When the morning is light, they carry it out, because it is in the power of their hand. |
| 2 | <i>And they covet fields, and take them by violence; and houses, and take them away: so they oppress a man and his house, even a man and his heritage.</i> | They covet fields and seize them by violence. They covet houses and take them away. They oppress a man and his house, even a man and his inheritance. |
| 3 | <i>Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I am devising against this family an evil, from which ye shall not remove your necks; neither shall ye go haughtily: for this time is evil.</i> | Therefore the LORD says: I am devising against this family a disaster from which You will not remove Your necks. You will not walk proudly, for this time is evil. |
| 4 | <i>In that day shall one take up a parable against you, and lament with a doleful lamentation, and say, We be utterly spoiled: he hath changed the portion of my people: how hath he removed it from me! turning away he hath divided our fields.</i> | In that day someone will take up a proverb against you and lament with a bitter lamentation, saying, "We are utterly ruined. He has changed the portion of my people. How He has taken it from me! He has turned away and divided our fields." |
| 5 | <i>Therefore thou shalt have none that shall cast a cord by lot in the congregation of the LORD.</i> | Therefore You will have no one to cast a measuring line by lot in the congregation of the LORD. |

- 6 *Prophesy ye not, say they to them that prophesy: they shall not prophesy to them, that they shall not take shame.* "Do not prophesy," they say to those who prophesy. They will not prophesy to them, so that disgrace will not overtake them.
- 7 *O thou that art named the house of Jacob, is the spirit of the LORD straitened? are these his doings? do not my words do good to him that walketh uprightly?* O You who are called the house of Jacob, is the Spirit of the LORD restricted? Are these His doings? Do not My words do good to the one who walks uprightly?
- 8 *Even of late my people is risen up as an enemy: ye pull off the robe with the garment from them that pass by securely as men averse from war.* Even lately My people have risen up as an enemy. You pull off the robe along with the garment from those who pass by securely, as men turning away from war.
- 9 *The women of my people have ye cast out from their pleasant houses; from their children have ye taken away my glory for ever.* You have cast out the women of My people from their pleasant houses. From their children You have taken away My glory forever.
- 10 *Arise ye, and depart; for this is not your rest: because it is polluted, it shall destroy you, even with a sore destruction.* Arise and depart, for this is not Your rest. Because it is defiled, it will destroy You with a grievous destruction.
- 11 *If a man walking in the spirit and falsehood do lie, saying, I will prophesy unto thee of wine and of strong drink; he shall even be the prophet of this people.* If a man walking in a spirit of falsehood lies, saying, "I will prophesy to you of wine and of strong drink" — he will be the prophet of this people.
- 12 *I will surely assemble, O Jacob, all of thee; I will surely gather the remnant of Israel; I will put them together as the sheep of Bozrah, as the flock in the midst of their fold: they shall make great noise by reason of the multitude of men.* I will surely assemble all of you, O Jacob. I will surely gather the remnant of Israel. I will put them together like the sheep of Bozrah, like a flock in the middle of its fold. They will make a great noise because of the crowd of people.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **The remnant** (REM-nunt) — A key theological term in the Old Testament prophets. The "remnant" is the small faithful portion of God's people preserved through judgment — a believing minority left after the unfaithful many have fallen. Through the remnant God keeps His covenant promises alive. Paul applies the term to the saved among Israel in Romans 9–11.

- 13 *The breaker is come up before them: they have broken up, and have passed through the gate, and are gone out by it: and their king shall pass before them, and the LORD on the head of them.*
- The One who breaks through has gone up before them. They have broken out, passed through the gate, and gone out by it. Their king will pass before them, and the LORD at their head.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 36:4; Isa 32:7; Ps 7:14-16; Hos 7:6-7; Nah 1:11
- v2 — Isa 5:8; Jer 22:17; Amos 8:4
- v3 — Amos 5:13; Isa 2:11-12; Jer 8:3; Jer 18:11; Lam 5:5
- v6 — Amos 2:12; Isa 30:10
- v7 — Ps 84:11; Jer 15:16; Ps 15:2
- v10 — Deut 12:9; Ps 106:38; Heb 4:1-9; 2 Kgs 17:6; Lev 20:22-26
- v11 — Jer 5:31; Isa 30:10-11; 2 Cor 11:13-15; Jer 23:17
- v12 — Mic 4:6-7
- v13 — Isa 52:12; Zech 9:14-15; Isa 45:1-2; Heb 2:14-15; Rev 7:17

Chapter 3

Micah rebukes the leaders of Israel who hate good and love evil, who tear the skin from the people and eat their flesh. The prophets lead the people astray — they cry "Peace" when they are fed, but declare war against those who give them nothing. Because of them, Zion will be plowed like a field and Jerusalem will become heaps of rubble.

- 1 *And I said, Hear, I pray you, O heads of Jacob, and ye princes of the house of Israel; Is it not for you to know judgment?*
- And I said, "Hear, I ask you, O heads of Jacob, and you princes of the house of Israel. Is it not for you to know justice?
- 2 *Who hate the good, and love the evil; who pluck off their skin from off them, and their flesh from off their bones;*
- You who hate the good and love the evil, who tear the skin from off My people and the flesh from off their bones —

- 3 *Who also eat the flesh of my people, and flay their skin from off them; and they break their bones, and chop them in pieces, as for the pot, and as flesh within the caldron.* who also eat the flesh of My people and strip their skin from them, who break their bones and chop them in pieces, like meat for the pot, like flesh within the cauldron."
- 4 *Then shall they cry unto the LORD, but he will not hear them: he will even hide his face from them at that time, as they have behaved themselves ill in their doings.* Then they will cry to the LORD, but He will not hear them. He will even hide His face from them at that time, because they have done evil in their deeds.
- 5 *Thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that make my people err, that bite with their teeth, and cry, Peace; and he that putteth not into their mouths, they even prepare war against him:* This is what the LORD says concerning the prophets who lead My people astray, who bite with their teeth and cry, "Peace" — but who prepare war against anyone who does not put food into their mouths:
- 6 *Therefore night shall be unto you, that ye shall not have a vision; and it shall be dark unto you, that ye shall not divine; and the sun shall go down over the prophets, and the day shall be dark over them.* Therefore it will be night to You, without a vision. It will be dark to You, without divination. The sun will go down on the prophets, and the day will be dark over them.
- 7 *Then shall the seers be ashamed, and the diviners confounded: yea, they shall all cover their lips; for there is no answer of God.* Then the seers will be ashamed and the diviners confounded. They will all cover their lips, for there is no answer from God.
- 8 *But truly I am full of power by the spirit of the LORD, and of judgment, and of might, to declare unto Jacob his transgression, and to Israel his sin.* But truly I am full of power by the Spirit of the LORD, and of justice and might, to declare to Jacob his transgression and to Israel his sin.
- 9 *Hear this, I pray you, ye heads of the house of Jacob, and princes of the house of Israel, that abhor judgment, and pervert all equity.* Hear this, I ask you, you heads of the house of Jacob and princes of the house of Israel, who hate justice and pervert all that is right.

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| <p>10 <i>They build up Zion with blood, and Jerusalem with iniquity.</i></p> <p>11 <i>The heads thereof judge for reward, and the priests thereof teach for hire, and the prophets thereof divine for money: yet will they lean upon the LORD, and say, Is not the LORD among us? none evil can come upon us.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Therefore shall Zion for your sake be plowed as a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of the forest.</i></p> | <p>They build up Zion with blood, and Jerusalem with iniquity.</p> <p>Her heads judge for a bribe, her priests teach for hire, and her prophets divine for money. Yet they lean on the LORD and say, "Is not the LORD among us? No evil can come upon us."</p> <p>Therefore for Your sake Zion will be plowed like a field, Jerusalem will become heaps of ruins, and the mountain of the house will be like the high places of a forest.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ezek 22:27; Prov 28:4; Ps 53:4
v3 — Ps 14:4
v4 — Isa 1:15; Prov 1:28; Ezek 8:18; Ps 18:41
v5 — Jer 14:14-15; Jer 6:14; Ezek 22:25-29; Jer 23:32; Isa 9:15-16
v6 — Isa 8:20-22
v7 — Isa 44:25
v8 — Isa 58:1; 1 Cor 2:12-13; 1 Cor 2:4; Isa 11:2-3
v9 — Isa 1:23; Ps 58:1-2
v10 — Hab 2:9-12
v11 — Jer 6:13; Isa 1:23; Mic 3:5; Jer 7:4; Titus 1:11
v12 — Jer 26:18; Ps 79:1

Chapter 4

In the last days the mountain of the LORD's house will be established above all mountains, and nations will flow to it. They will beat their swords into plowshares, and nation will not lift up sword against nation. Though Israel now goes into exile in Babylon, the LORD will redeem her there and gather her like sheaves to the threshing floor.

- 1 *But in the last days it shall come to pass, that the mountain of the house of the LORD shall be established in the top of the mountains, and it shall be exalted above the hills; and people shall flow unto it.* But in the last days it will come to pass that the mountain of the house of the LORD will be established in the top of the mountains, and it will be exalted above the hills. And peoples will flow to it.
- 2 *And many nations shall come, and say, Come, and let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, and to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths: for the law shall go forth of Zion, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.* Many nations will come and say, "Come, let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, and to the house of the God of Jacob. He will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in His paths." For the law will go forth out of Zion, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.
- 3 *And he shall judge among many people, and rebuke strong nations afar off; and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.* He will judge among many peoples and rebuke strong nations far away. They will beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will not lift up a sword against nation, nor will they learn war any more.
- 4 *But they shall sit every man under his vine and under his fig tree; and none shall make them afraid: for the mouth of the LORD of hosts hath spoken it.* Every man will sit under his vine and under his fig tree, and no one will make them afraid, for the mouth of the LORD of hosts has spoken it.
- 5 *For all people will walk every one in the name of his god, and we will walk in the name of the LORD our God for ever and ever.* For all peoples will walk, every one in the name of his god — but we will walk in the name of the LORD our God for ever and ever.
- 6 *In that day, saith the LORD, will I assemble her that halteth, and I will gather her that is driven out, and her that I have afflicted;* In that day, says the LORD, I will assemble the lame. I will gather the one driven away, and the one I have afflicted.

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| <p>7 <i>And I will make her that halted a remnant, and her that was cast far off a strong nation: and the LORD shall reign over them in mount Zion from henceforth, even for ever.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And thou, O tower of the flock, the strong hold of the daughter of Zion, unto thee shall it come, even the first dominion; the kingdom shall come to the daughter of Jerusalem.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Now why dost thou cry out aloud? is there no king in thee? is thy counsellor perished? for pangs have taken thee as a woman in travail.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Be in pain, and labour to bring forth, O daughter of Zion, like a woman in travail: for now shalt thou go forth out of the city, and thou shalt dwell in the field, and thou shalt go even to Babylon; there shalt thou be delivered; there the LORD shall redeem thee from the hand of thine enemies.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Now also many nations are gathered against thee, that say, Let her be defiled, and let our eye look upon Zion.</i></p> | <p>I will make the lame a remnant, and the one cast far off a strong nation. The LORD will reign over them in Mount Zion from now on, even for ever.</p> <p>And You, O tower of the flock, the stronghold of the daughter of Zion — to You it will come, even the former dominion. The kingdom will come to the daughter of Jerusalem.</p> <p>Now why do You cry out aloud? Is there no king in You? Has Your counselor perished, that pains have seized You like a woman in labor?</p> <p>Be in pain and labor to bring forth, O daughter of Zion, like a woman in labor. For now you will go forth out of the city, and You will live in the field. You will go even to Babylon. There You will be delivered. There the LORD will redeem You from the hand of Your enemies.</p> <p>Now also many nations are gathered against You, who say, "Let her be defiled, and let our eye gaze on Zion."</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Heathen** (HEE-thun) — Used here (and at 5:8, 5:15, 7:16) for the Gentile nations outside Israel's covenant — the pagan peoples in their ignorance of the true God. KJV uses "heathen" throughout the prophets for these nations.

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| <p>12 <i>But they know not the thoughts of the LORD, neither understand they his counsel: for he shall gather them as the sheaves into the floor.</i></p> | <p>But they do not know the thoughts of the LORD, nor do they understand His counsel. For He will gather them like sheaves to the threshing floor.</p> |
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- 13 *Arise and thresh, O daughter of Zion: for I will make thine horn iron, and I will make thy hoofs brass: and thou shalt beat in pieces many people: and I will consecrate their gain unto the LORD, and their substance unto the Lord of the whole earth.* Arise and thresh, O daughter of Zion. For I will make your horn iron, and I will make your hooves bronze. You will beat in pieces many peoples, and I will consecrate their gain to the LORD, their wealth to the Lord of the whole earth.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 2:1-4; Jer 3:17; Ps 22:27; Acts 2:17; Zech 14:16-21
v2 — Isa 2:3; Jer 31:6; Isa 54:13; Acts 1:8; Zech 14:8-9
v3 — Isa 2:4; Joel 3:9-16; Matt 25:31-32; Hos 2:18
v4 — Zech 3:10; 1 Kgs 4:25; Isa 1:20; Ezek 39:26; Isa 54:14
v5 — Zech 10:12; Josh 24:15; Col 3:17; Ps 145:1-2; Isa 2:5
v6 — Zeph 3:19; Ezek 34:12-17; Isa 56:8
v7 — Dan 7:14; Luke 1:33; Isa 24:23; Mic 5:7-8; Mic 2:12
v8 — Isa 1:26; Zech 9:10; Rev 22:5
v9 — Jer 8:19
v10 — Isa 48:20; Isa 52:9-12; Hos 13:13; Isa 45:13; Hos 2:14
v11 — Obad 1:12
v13 — Isa 41:15-16; Dan 2:44; Zech 9:13-15; Isa 23:18; Isa 18:7

Chapter 5

Out of Bethlehem Ephratah — small among the clans of Judah — will come forth the ruler of Israel, whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting. He will stand and shepherd His flock in the strength of the LORD. The remnant of Jacob will be among the nations like a lion among flocks of sheep, and the LORD will cut off all idols, witchcraft, and graven images.

- 1 *Now gather thyself in troops, O daughter of troops: he hath laid siege against us: they shall smite the judge of Israel with a rod upon the cheek.* Now gather Yourself in troops, O daughter of troops. He has laid siege against us. They will strike the judge of Israel on the cheek with a rod.

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| <p>2 <i>But thou, Beth-lehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.</i></p> | <p>But you, Bethlehem Ephratah, though you be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of you shall He come forth unto Me that is to be ruler in Israel — whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bethlehem Ephratah** (BETH-leh-hem EF-rah-tah) — Bethlehem means "house of bread"; Ephratah ("fruitful") is the older name of the district. Bethlehem was the hometown of David (1 Samuel 16:1) and the birthplace of Jesus Christ (Matthew 2:1, Luke 2:4). This verse is the Old Testament's single clearest prediction of the Messiah's birthplace — quoted by the chief priests to Herod in Matthew 2:6. "Whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting" testifies to the eternal pre-existence of the Christ.

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| <p>3 <i>Therefore will he give them up, until the time that she which travaileth hath brought forth: then the remnant of his brethren shall return unto the children of Israel.</i></p> | <p>Therefore He will give them up, until the time when she who is in labor has brought forth. Then the remnant of His brothers will return to the children of Israel.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And he shall stand and feed in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD his God; and they shall abide: for now shall he be great unto the ends of the earth.</i></p> | <p>He will stand and feed his flock in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD His God. And they will abide, for now He will be great to the ends of the earth.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And this man shall be the peace, when the Assyrian shall come into our land: and when he shall tread in our palaces, then shall we raise against him seven shepherds, and eight principal men.</i></p> | <p>And this Man will be the peace, when the Assyrian comes into our land. When he treads in our palaces, then we will raise against him seven shepherds and eight principal men.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Assyria** (uh-SEE-ree-uh) — The empire to the northeast of Israel, with its capital at Nineveh. In Micah's day Assyria was the rising power of the ancient world. It destroyed the northern kingdom (Samaria) in 722 BC and invaded Judah under Sennacherib in 701 BC. In this passage "the Assyrian" stands for every enemy of God's people that will be broken before the Messiah.

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| <p>6 <i>And they shall waste the land of Assyria with the sword, and the land of Nimrod in the entrances thereof: thus shall he deliver us from the Assyrian, when he cometh into our land, and when he treadeth within our borders.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the remnant of Jacob shall be in the midst of many people as a dew from the LORD, as the showers upon the grass, that tarrieth not for man, nor waiteth for the sons of men.</i></p> | <p>They will lay waste the land of Assyria with the sword, and the land of Nimrod at its entrances. So He will deliver us from the Assyrian when He comes into our land and treads within our borders.</p> <p>The remnant of Jacob will be in the midst of many peoples like dew from the LORD, like showers on the grass — which does not wait for man nor delay for the sons of men.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Gentiles** (JEN-tylez) — *The nations outside Israel; the same peoples elsewhere called "heathen."* "Gentile" comes from Latin and "heathen" from Old English, but both translate the same Hebrew word (*goyim*).

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| <p>8 <i>And the remnant of Jacob shall be among the Gentiles in the midst of many people as a lion among the beasts of the forest, as a young lion among the flocks of sheep: who, if he go through, both treadeth down, and teareth in pieces, and none can deliver.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Thine hand shall be lifted up upon thine adversaries, and all thine enemies shall be cut off.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD, that I will cut off thy horses out of the midst of thee, and I will destroy thy chariots:</i></p> <p>11 <i>And I will cut off the cities of thy land, and throw down all thy strong holds:</i></p> <p>12 <i>And I will cut off witchcrafts out of thine hand; and thou shalt have no more soothsayers:</i></p> | <p>The remnant of Jacob will be among the Gentiles, in the midst of many peoples, like a lion among the beasts of the forest, like a young lion among the flocks of sheep — which, when it passes through, both tramples down and tears in pieces, and none can deliver.</p> <p>Your hand will be lifted up against your adversaries, and all your enemies will be cut off.</p> <p>It will come to pass in that day, says the LORD, that I will cut off Your horses from among You, and I will destroy Your chariots.</p> <p>I will cut off the cities of Your land and throw down all Your strongholds.</p> <p>I will cut off witchcrafts from Your hand, and You will have no more soothsayers.</p> |
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| <p>13 <i>Thy graven images also will I cut off, and thy standing images out of the midst of thee; and thou shalt no more worship the work of thine hands.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And I will pluck up thy groves out of the midst of thee: so will I destroy thy cities.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And I will execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen, such as they have not heard.</i></p> | <p>I will also cut off Your graven images and Your standing pillars from among You. You will no more worship the work of Your hands.</p> <p>I will pluck up Your groves from among You, and so I will destroy Your cities.</p> <p>I will execute vengeance in anger and fury on the heathen, such as they have not heard.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lam 3:30
- v2 — Matt 2:6; John 7:42; Isa 9:6-7; Luke 1:31-33; Ps 90:2
- v3 — Rev 12:1-2; Matt 1:21; Rom 9:27-28; Mic 4:7
- v4 — Isa 40:10-11; Ps 23:1-2; Luke 1:32; Mic 7:14
- v5 — Luke 2:14
- v7 — Ps 72:6; Mic 5:3; Isa 44:3; Deut 32:2; Hos 14:5
- v8 — Zech 10:5
- v10 — Zech 9:10; Hos 14:3
- v12 — Deut 18:10-12; Isa 8:19-20; Rev 22:15; Isa 2:20

Chapter 6

The LORD brings His case against Israel before the mountains. He asks what He has done to weary them — He brought them out of Egypt, sent Moses, Aaron, and Miriam before them. What does the LORD require? "To do justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God." Yet the city is full of violence and deceit, and judgment will fall.

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| <p>1 <i>Hear ye now what the LORD saith; Arise, contend thou before the mountains, and let the hills hear thy voice.</i></p> | <p>Hear now what the LORD says: "Arise, contend before the mountains, and let the hills hear Your voice.</p> |
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| 2 <i>Hear ye, O mountains, the LORD's controversy, and ye strong foundations of the earth: for the LORD hath a controversy with his people, and he will plead with Israel.</i> | Hear, O mountains, the LORD's controversy — and You strong foundations of the earth. For the LORD has a controversy with His people, and He will plead with Israel. |
| 3 <i>O my people, what have I done unto thee? and wherein have I wearied thee? testify against me.</i> | O My people, what have I done to you? How have I wearied you? Testify against Me. |
| 4 <i>For I brought thee up out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed thee out of the house of servants; and I sent before thee Moses, Aaron, and Miriam.</i> | For I brought you up out of the land of Egypt and redeemed you out of the house of servants. I sent before you Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. |
| 5 <i>O my people, remember now what Balak king of Moab consulted, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered him from Shittim unto Gilgal; that ye may know the righteousness of the LORD.</i> | O My people, remember now what Balak king of Moab consulted, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered Him — from Shittim to Gilgal — that You may know the righteousness of the LORD." |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Balak** (BAY-lak) — King of Moab in the days of Moses; he hired the prophet Balaam to curse Israel as they camped on the plains of Moab before entering the Promised Land (Numbers 22–24). God turned every curse into a blessing.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Balaam** (BAY-lum) — Son of Beor; a prophet from Pethor on the Euphrates whom Balak hired to curse Israel. Though he spoke true words from God when forced (Numbers 23–24), Balaam loved the wages of unrighteousness (2 Peter 2:15) and later led Israel into sin at Peor (Numbers 25, 31:16; Revelation 2:14).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Beor** (BEE-or) — The father of Balaam.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Shittim** (SHIT-tim) — Also called Abel-shittim; the last camp of Israel on the east side of the Jordan, on the plains of Moab opposite Jericho. It was here Balak and Balaam's plot unfolded and here Israel sinned with the daughters of Moab (Numbers 25).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gilgal** (GIL-gal) — The first camp of Israel west of the Jordan after they crossed on dry ground under Joshua. Here they were circumcised and kept the first Passover in the land (Joshua 4–5). "From Shittim to Gilgal" sums up Israel's miraculous entry into the Promised Land.

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| 6 | <i>Wherewith shall I come before the LORD, and bow myself before the high God? shall I come before him with burnt offerings, with calves of a year old?</i> | With what shall I come before the LORD, and bow myself before the high God? Shall I come before Him with burnt offerings, with calves a year old? |
| 7 | <i>Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams, or with ten thousands of rivers of oil? shall I give my firstborn for my transgression, the fruit of my body for the sin of my soul?</i> | Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams, or with ten thousand rivers of oil? Shall I give my firstborn for my transgression, the fruit of my body for the sin of my soul? |
| 8 | <i>He hath shewed thee, O man, what is good; and what doth the LORD require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God?</i> | He hath shewed you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God? |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. The Hebrew word here (*chesed*) is the great covenant word — God's faithful, loyal love to His people, which He commands them to show one another. KJV translates it "mercy" or "lovingkindness," never "steadfast love."

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| 9 | <i>The LORD's voice crieth unto the city, and the man of wisdom shall see thy name: hear ye the rod, and who hath appointed it.</i> | The LORD's voice cries to the city, and the man of wisdom will see your name. Hear the rod, and Him who appointed it. |
| 10 | <i>Are there yet the treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and the scant measure that is abominable?</i> | Are there yet treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and the scant measure that is abominable? |
| 11 | <i>Shall I count them pure with the wicked balances, and with the bag of deceitful weights?</i> | Shall I count them pure with wicked balances and with a bag of deceitful weights? |

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| <p>12 <i>For the rich men thereof are full of violence, and the inhabitants thereof have spoken lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their mouth.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Therefore also will I make thee sick in smiting thee, in making thee desolate because of thy sins.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Thou shalt eat, but not be satisfied; and thy casting down shall be in the midst of thee; and thou shalt take hold, but shalt not deliver; and that which thou deliverest will I give up to the sword.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Thou shalt sow, but thou shalt not reap; thou shalt tread the olives, but thou shalt not anoint thee with oil; and sweet wine, but shalt not drink wine.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of the house of Ahab, and ye walk in their counsels; that I should make thee a desolation, and the inhabitants thereof an hissing: therefore ye shall bear the reproach of my people.</i></p> | <p>For her rich men are full of violence, her inhabitants have spoken lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their mouth.</p> <p>Therefore I also will make you sick by striking you, by making you desolate because of your sins.</p> <p>You will eat, but not be satisfied. Your hunger will be in the midst of you. You will take hold, but you will not save, and what you save I will give up to the sword.</p> <p>You will sow, but you will not reap. You will tread the olives, but you will not anoint yourself with oil. You will tread sweet wine, but you will not drink wine.</p> <p>For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of the house of Ahab, and you walk in their counsels. So I will make you a desolation, and her inhabitants a hissing. Therefore you will bear the reproach of My people.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Omri** (OM-ree) — King of the northern kingdom of Israel c. 885–874 BC; founder of the dynasty that included his son Ahab. Omri built Samaria as his capital (1 Kings 16:24) and "did worse than all that were before him" (1 Kings 16:25). His "statutes" were the corrupt patterns of idolatry and injustice he established.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ahab** (AY-hab) — Son of Omri; king of Israel c. 874–853 BC. He married Jezebel of Sidon, set up Baal worship in Samaria, and persecuted the prophets of the LORD (1 Kings 16–22). The "house of Ahab" stands for the most concentrated wickedness of the northern kingdom.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 22:29; Deut 32:1; Mic 1:2; Ezek 36:1; Ps 50:4
v2 — Hos 4:1; Hos 12:2; Isa 1:18
v3 — Jer 2:5; Isa 43:22-23; Jer 2:31; Ps 81:13
v4 — Deut 7:8; Ex 12:51; Ps 136:10-11
v5 — Josh 5:9-10; Num 25:1; Judg 5:11; 2 Pet 2:15; Deut 16:3
v6 — Ps 51:16-17; Rom 10:2-3; Ps 40:6-8
v7 — 2 Kgs 16:3; Ps 51:16; 1 Sam 15:22; Ps 50:9; Hos 6:6
v8 — Deut 10:12-13; Prov 21:3; Col 3:12; Jer 22:3; Hos 6:6
v11 — Hos 12:7
v12 — Hos 7:13; Jer 9:8; Isa 1:23
v14 — Hos 4:10; Isa 65:13
v15 — Zeph 1:13; Amos 5:11

Chapter 7

Micah laments — the godly man has perished, every man hunts his brother with a net, and a man's enemies are the men of his own household. Yet "I will look to the LORD; I will wait for the God of my salvation." The LORD will shepherd His people again, the nations will see and be ashamed. Who is a God like the LORD — who pardons iniquity and casts all their sins into the depths of the sea?

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| <p>1 <i>Woe is me! for I am as when they have gathered the summer fruits, as the grape gleanings of the vintage: there is no cluster to eat: my soul desired the firstripe fruit.</i></p> | <p>Woe is me! For I am like one when they have gathered the summer fruits, like the grape gleanings of the vintage. There is no cluster to eat. My soul desired the firstripe fruit.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>The good man is perished out of the earth: and there is none upright among men: they all lie in wait for blood; they hunt every man his brother with a net.</i></p> | <p>The good man has perished from the earth, and there is no one upright among men. They all lie in wait for blood. Every man hunts his brother with a net.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>That they may do evil with both hands earnestly, the prince asketh, and the judge asketh for a reward; and the great man, he uttereth his mischievous desire: so they wrap it up.</i></p> | <p>They do evil with both hands eagerly. The prince asks, and the judge asks for a bribe. The great man speaks out his evil desire, and so they weave it together.</p> |

- 4 *The best of them is as a brier: the most upright is sharper than a thorn hedge: the day of thy watchmen and thy visitation cometh; now shall be their perplexity.* The best of them is like a brier. The most upright is sharper than a thorn hedge. The day of your watchmen — your visitation — comes. Now will be their confusion.
- 5 *Trust ye not in a friend, put ye not confidence in a guide: keep the doors of thy mouth from her that lieth in thy bosom.* Do not trust in a friend. Do not put confidence in a guide. Keep the doors of your mouth from her who lies in your bosom.
- 6 *For the son dishonoureth the father, the daughter riseth up against her mother, the daughter in law against her mother in law; a man's enemies are the men of his own house.* For the son dishonors the father. The daughter rises up against her mother, the daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law. A man's enemies are the men of his own house.
- 7 *Therefore I will look unto the LORD; I will wait for the God of my salvation: my God will hear me.* Therefore I will look to the LORD. I will wait for the God of my salvation. My God will hear me.
- 8 *Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy: when I fall, I shall arise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD shall be a light unto me.* Rejoice not against me, O my enemy. When I fall, I will arise. When I sit in darkness, the LORD will be a light to me.
- 9 *I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have sinned against him, until he plead my cause, and execute judgment for me: he will bring me forth to the light, and I shall behold his righteousness.* I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have sinned against Him — until He pleads my cause and executes judgment for me. He will bring me forth to the light, and I will see His righteousness.
- 10 *Then she that is mine enemy shall see it, and shame shall cover her which said unto me, Where is the LORD thy God? mine eyes shall behold her: now shall she be trodden down as the mire of the streets.* Then she who is my enemy will see it, and shame will cover her who said to me, "Where is the LORD Your God?" My eyes will see her. Now she will be trodden down like the mire of the streets.

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| <p>11 <i>In the day that thy walls are to be built, in that day shall the decree be far removed.</i></p> <p>12 <i>In that day also he shall come even to thee from Assyria, and from the fortified cities, and from the fortress even to the river, and from sea to sea, and from mountain to mountain.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Notwithstanding the land shall be desolate because of them that dwell therein, for the fruit of their doings.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Feed thy people with thy rod, the flock of thine heritage, which dwell solitarily in the wood, in the midst of Carmel: let them feed in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old.</i></p> | <p>In the day when Your walls are to be built — in that day the decree will be far removed.</p> <p>In that day also He will come to You from Assyria, and from the fortified cities, and from the fortress even to the river, from sea to sea and from mountain to mountain.</p> <p>Yet the land will be desolate because of those who live in it, for the fruit of their doings.</p> <p>Feed Your people with Your rod, the flock of Your heritage, which dwell alone in the wood, in the midst of Carmel. Let them feed in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bashan** (BAY-shun) — A rich pastoral region east of the Sea of Galilee, north of Gilead, famous for its fat cattle and oak forests (Psalm 22:12; Isaiah 2:13). Part of the inheritance of the half-tribe of Manasseh.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gilead** (GIL-ee-ad) — The mountainous region east of the Jordan River, between Bashan to the north and Moab to the south. Settled by Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh; famed for its balm (Jeremiah 8:22).

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| <p>15 <i>According to the days of thy coming out of the land of Egypt will I shew unto him marvellous things.</i></p> <p>16 <i>The nations shall see and be confounded at all their might: they shall lay their hand upon their mouth, their ears shall be deaf.</i></p> <p>17 <i>They shall lick the dust like a serpent, they shall move out of their holes like worms of the earth: they shall be afraid of the LORD our God, and shall fear because of thee.</i></p> | <p>As in the days when You came out of the land of Egypt, I will show Him marvellous things.</p> <p>The nations will see and be confounded at all their might. They will lay their hand on their mouth. Their ears will be deaf.</p> <p>They will lick the dust like a serpent. They will move out of their holes like worms of the earth. They will be afraid of the LORD our God, and will fear because of You.</p> |
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| <p>18 <i>Who is a God like unto thee, that pardoneth iniquity, and passeth by the transgression of the remnant of his heritage? he retaineth not his anger for ever, because he delighteth in mercy.</i></p> <p>19 <i>He will turn again, he will have compassion upon us; he will subdue our iniquities; and thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Thou wilt perform the truth to Jacob, and the mercy to Abraham, which thou hast sworn unto our fathers from the days of old.</i></p> | <p>Who is a God like unto You, that pardoneth iniquity, and passeth by the transgression of the remnant of His heritage? He retaineth not His anger for ever, because He delighteth in mercy.</p> <p>He will turn again. He will have compassion upon us. He will subdue our iniquities, and You will cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.</p> <p>You will perform the truth to Jacob and the mercy to Abraham, which You have sworn unto our fathers from the days of old.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Abraham** (AY-bra-ham) — "father of a multitude" — *The patriarch with whom God made the foundational covenant: "in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed" (Genesis 22:18). Micah closes the book by appealing to this oldest of God's promises — the mercy sworn to Abraham, kept across the generations, fulfilled at last in Christ (Galatians 3:16).*

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 12:1; Ps 14:1-3; Jer 5:26; Isa 57:1; Isa 59:7
- v4 — Isa 22:5; Ezek 2:6; Isa 10:3; 2 Sam 23:6-7
- v5 — Jer 9:4; Ps 118:8-9; Matt 10:16; Job 6:14-15; Judg 16:5-20
- v6 — Matt 10:35-36; Luke 12:53; Matt 10:21; Ps 41:9; Ps 55:12-14
- v7 — Lam 3:25-26; Ps 37:7; 1 John 5:14-15; Isa 45:22; Isa 25:9
- v8 — John 8:12; Ps 27:1; Isa 9:2; Ps 112:4; Ps 107:10-15
- v9 — 1 Cor 4:5; Ps 37:6
- v10 — Zech 10:5; Jer 50:33-34; Ps 42:10; Ps 35:26; Rev 18:20
- v14 — Ps 23:1-4; Mic 5:4; Ps 100:3; Isa 40:11
- v15 — Ps 78:12-72; Ex 3:20; Isa 51:9; Isa 63:11-15; Isa 11:16
- v18 — Isa 43:25; Isa 44:22; Eph 2:4-5; Ps 103:8-9; Jer 50:20
- v19 — Isa 38:17; Rom 6:14; Isa 43:25; Jer 31:34; Jer 50:20

Nahum

Author: Nahum the Elkoshite (1:1). Nothing else is known of him personally — not his father's name, not his tribe, not the dates of his ministry. His name and his hometown are all that remain of the man himself.

Date written: Between 663 BC (when Thebes fell, mentioned as past in 3:8) and 612 BC (when Nineveh itself fell). Probably c. 650–620 BC.

Written to: Nineveh — the capital of the Assyrian Empire — and by extension to Judah, as comfort. The name "Nahum" means "comfort"; the whole book is the comfort that Assyria, the great oppressor, will fall.

Setting: A century before Nahum, the prophet Jonah had been sent to Nineveh, and the city had repented. By Nahum's day, Assyria had returned to its ferocious cruelty — sacking Israel (722 BC), besieging Jerusalem (701 BC), and ruling the ancient Near East with terror. Nahum prophesies the imminent and total destruction of Nineveh. His prophecy was fulfilled with stunning precision in 612 BC when a coalition of Medes, Babylonians, and Scythians sacked Nineveh so thoroughly that the city was lost to history until rediscovered in the 1840s.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 650–620 BC under the reigns of Manasseh and Josiah of Judah, after Assyria's sack of Thebes in 663 BC but before the coalition of Medes and Babylonians destroyed Nineveh in 612 BC.

Contemporaries: Zephaniah was preaching in Jerusalem in the same window, while Jeremiah was just beginning his ministry and the young king Josiah was preparing the reforms of 622 BC.

Big themes:

- The LORD is slow to anger but great in power, and will not at all acquit the wicked (1:3)
- Divine judgment falls on nations that exalt themselves in cruelty
- The LORD is a stronghold in the day of trouble for those who trust Him (1:7)
- God's vengeance is real, righteous, and certain
- The eventual ruin of every oppressor — the comfort of the oppressed in God's certain justice

Key passages: Nahum 1:3 (slow to anger, great in power); 1:7 (the LORD is good, a stronghold); 1:15 (the feet of him that bringeth good tidings — quoted in Rom 10:15); 3:1 (woe to the bloody city).

How it fits: Nahum is the OT's chief oracle against Assyria. With Jonah (also addressed to Nineveh), it forms a two-book commentary on God's patience and God's wrath: Jonah preaches that God will spare a repentant Nineveh; Nahum, a century later, preaches that God will destroy an impenitent Nineveh. The doxological opening (1:2–8) is one of the OT's strongest celebrations of God's avenging holiness. Nahum 1:15's "feet of him that bringeth good tidings" is taken up by Paul in Romans 10:15 and applied to gospel preachers.

Chapter 1

The LORD is a jealous God who avenges and is furious — He will not acquit the wicked. He is longsuffering, but His way is in the whirlwind and the storm. He is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble, and He knows those who trust in Him. Nineveh's destruction is decreed — the LORD will make an utter end of her.

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The burden of Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.

A prophecy concerning Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nahum** (NAY-hum) — "comfort, consolation" — The Hebrew prophet who wrote this book; his very name proclaims the book's message: Assyria's fall is the comfort of God's oppressed people.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elkoshite** (EL-kosh-ite) — From Elkosh, an unknown town (possibly in southern Judah, possibly in Galilee; some traditions place it in Assyria itself among the Israelite exiles).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nineveh** (NIN-eh-veh) — Ancient capital of the Assyrian Empire on the east bank of the Tigris River (across from modern Mosul, Iraq); founded by Nimrod (Gen 10:11); the target of Jonah's preaching and now of Nahum's prophecy.

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God is jealous, and the LORD revengeth; the LORD revengeth, and is furious; the LORD will take vengeance on his adversaries, and he reserveth wrath for his enemies.

God is jealous, and the LORD takes vengeance. The LORD takes vengeance and is filled with fury. The LORD will take vengeance on His adversaries, and He reserves wrath for His enemies.
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The LORD is slow to anger, and great in power, and will not at all acquit the wicked: the LORD hath his way in the whirlwind and in the storm, and the clouds are the dust of his feet.

The LORD is slow to anger, and great in power, and will not at all acquit the wicked. The LORD has His way in the whirlwind and in the storm, and the clouds are the dust of His feet.
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He rebuketh the sea, and maketh it dry, and drieth up all the rivers: Bashan languisheth, and Carmel, and the flower of Lebanon languisheth.

He rebukes the sea and makes it dry; He dries up all the rivers. Bashan languishes, and Carmel, and the flower of Lebanon languishes.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bashan, Carmel, Lebanon** — Three famously fertile regions of the Levant; the LORD's anger withers them. Bashan is the rich pastureland east of the Sea of Galilee; Carmel is the fruitful mountain ridge by the Mediterranean; Lebanon is the famous land of the great cedars.

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| 5 | <i>The mountains quake at him, and the hills melt, and the earth is burned at his presence, yea, the world, and all that dwell therein.</i> | The mountains quake at Him, and the hills melt. The earth is burned at His presence — the world, and all who live in it. |
| 6 | <i>Who can stand before his indignation? and who can abide in the fierceness of his anger? his fury is poured out like fire, and the rocks are thrown down by him.</i> | Who can stand before His indignation? Who can endure the fierceness of His anger? His fury is poured out like fire, and the rocks are thrown down by Him. |
| 7 | <i>The LORD is good, a strong hold in the day of trouble; and he knoweth them that trust in him.</i> | The LORD is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble, and He knows those who trust in Him. |
| 8 | <i>But with an overrunning flood he will make an utter end of the place thereof, and darkness shall pursue his enemies.</i> | But with an overwhelming flood He will make an utter end of its place, and darkness will pursue His enemies. |
| 9 | <i>What do ye imagine against the LORD? he will make an utter end: affliction shall not rise up the second time.</i> | What do You plot against the LORD? He will make an utter end. Affliction will not rise up a second time. |
| 10 | <i>For while they be folden together as thorns, and while they are drunken as drunkards, they shall be devoured as stubble fully dry.</i> | For while they are tangled together like thorns, and while they are drunken as drunkards, they will be devoured like stubble fully dry. |
| 11 | <i>There is one come out of thee, that imagineth evil against the LORD, a wicked counsellor.</i> | One has come out from You who plots evil against the LORD — a wicked counselor of Belial. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Belial** (BEE-lee-al) — Hebrew for "worthlessness" or "wickedness" personified; in some passages a title for the devil; here, the wicked counselor coming out of Nineveh.

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| <p>12 <i>Thus saith the LORD; Though they be quiet, and likewise many, yet thus shall they be cut down, when he shall pass through. Though I have afflicted thee, I will afflict thee no more.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For now will I break his yoke from off thee, and will burst thy bonds in sunder.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the LORD hath given a commandment concerning thee, that no more of thy name be sown: out of the house of thy gods will I cut off the graven image and the molten image: I will make thy grave; for thou art vile.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Behold upon the mountains the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace! O Judah, keep thy solemn feasts, perform thy vows: for the wicked shall no more pass through thee; he is utterly cut off.</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD says: "Though they be at peace, and likewise many, even so they will be cut down when He passes through. Though I have afflicted You, I will afflict You no more.</p> <p>For now I will break His yoke from off You, and I will burst Your bonds apart."</p> <p>The LORD has given a commandment concerning You: "No more of Your name will be sown. Out of the house of Your gods I will cut off the carved image and the molten image. I will make Your grave, for You are vile."</p> <p>See on the mountains the feet of him who brings good tidings, who proclaims peace! O Judah, keep your solemn feasts and perform your vows. The wicked will no more pass through you; he is utterly cut off.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ex 20:5; Zech 8:2; Ex 34:14; Ps 94:1; Josh 24:19
v3 — Ps 147:5; Ex 34:6-7; Neh 9:17; Ps 103:8; Ps 104:3
v4 — Ps 106:9; Isa 33:9; Ps 114:5; Isa 44:27; Ps 114:3
v5 — Mic 1:4; 2 Sam 22:8; Jer 4:24
v6 — Jer 10:10; Mal 3:2
v7 — 2 Tim 2:19; John 10:27; Lam 3:25; John 10:14; Ps 91:1-2
v8 — Ezek 13:13; Isa 28:17; Isa 8:22
v9 — Ps 21:11; Prov 21:30; Ps 33:10; 2 Cor 10:5; Ps 2:1-4
v10 — Mic 7:4; Nah 3:11; Mal 4:1; Isa 5:24
v11 — Nah 1:9; 2 Chr 13:7
v13 — Isa 10:27; Isa 9:4; Ps 107:14; Jer 2:20; Isa 14:25
v15 — Isa 52:7; Rom 10:15; Isa 40:9-10; Acts 10:36; Isa 29:7-8

Chapter 2

The destroyer advances against Nineveh — chariots race through the streets like lightning, the gates of the rivers are opened, and the palace dissolves. The city that was once the den of lions is plundered and emptied. The LORD of hosts declares He is against her, and her chariots will burn in the smoke.

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| 1 | <i>He that dasheth in pieces is come up before thy face: keep the munition, watch the way, make thy loins strong, fortify thy power mightily.</i> | He who dashes in pieces has come up against your face. Guard the fortress, watch the road, brace Your loins, fortify Your power mightily. |
| 2 | <i>For the LORD hath turned away the excellency of Jacob, as the excellency of Israel: for the emptiers have emptied them out, and marred their vine branches.</i> | For the LORD will restore the excellency of Jacob as the excellency of Israel — for the emptiers have emptied them out and marred their vine branches. |
| 3 | <i>The shield of his mighty men is made red, the valiant men are in scarlet: the chariots shall be with flaming torches in the day of his preparation, and the fir trees shall be terribly shaken.</i> | The shield of His mighty men is made red; the valiant men are in scarlet. The chariots are with flaming torches in the day of His preparation, and the fir spears are terribly shaken. |
| 4 | <i>The chariots shall rage in the streets, they shall jostle one against another in the broad ways: they shall seem like torches, they shall run like the lightnings.</i> | The chariots rage in the streets; they jostle one against another in the broad ways. They seem like torches; they run like the lightnings. |
| 5 | <i>He shall recount his worthies: they shall stumble in their walk; they shall make haste to the wall thereof, and the defence shall be prepared.</i> | He calls together His nobles; they stumble in their walk. They make haste to the wall, and the defense is prepared. |
| 6 | <i>The gates of the rivers shall be opened, and the palace shall be dissolved.</i> | The gates of the rivers are opened, and the palace is dissolved. |
| 7 | <i>And Huzzab shall be led away captive, she shall be brought up, and her maids shall lead her as with the voice of doves, tabering upon their breasts.</i> | And Huzzab will be led away captive; she will be brought up, and her maids will lead her with the voice of doves, beating on their breasts. |

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| <p>8 <i>But Nineveh is of old like a pool of water: yet they shall flee away. Stand, stand, shall they cry; but none shall look back.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Take ye the spoil of silver, take the spoil of gold: for there is none end of the store and glory out of all the pleasant furniture.</i></p> <p>10 <i>She is empty, and void, and waste: and the heart melteth, and the knees smite together, and much pain is in all loins, and the faces of them all gather blackness.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Where is the dwelling of the lions, and the feedingplace of the young lions, where the lion, even the old lion, walked, and the lion's whelp, and none made them afraid?</i></p> <p>12 <i>The lion did tear in pieces enough for his whelps, and strangled for his lionesses, and filled his holes with prey, and his dens with ravin.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword shall devour thy young lions: and I will cut off thy prey from the earth, and the voice of thy messengers shall no more be heard.</i></p> | <p>But Nineveh of old is like a pool of water, yet they flee away. "Stand! Stand!" they will cry, but none looks back.</p> <p>Take the spoil of silver! Take the spoil of gold! There is no end of the store and glory out of all the pleasant furniture.</p> <p>She is empty, and void, and waste. The heart melts; the knees strike together; much pain is in all loins; and the faces of them all gather blackness.</p> <p>Where is the dwelling of the lions, the feeding place of the young lions, where the lion, even the old lion, walked, and the lion's whelp, with none to make them afraid?</p> <p>The lion tore in pieces enough for His whelps, and strangled for His lionesses, and filled His holes with prey, and His dens with ravin.</p> <p>"I am against You," says the LORD of hosts. "I will burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword will devour Your young lions. I will cut off Your prey from the earth, and the voice of Your messengers will be heard no more."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 3:9-11; 2 Chr 25:8; Jer 51:20-23; Jer 51:11-12
v2 — Ezek 37:23; Ps 80:12-13
v5 — Jer 46:12

v7 — Isa 38:14; Isa 59:11

v10 — Joel 2:6; Dan 5:6; Ps 22:14

v11 — Isa 5:29

v13 — Ps 46:9; Nah 3:5; Jer 21:13; 2 Kgs 19:23

Chapter 3

Woe to the bloody city of Nineveh — full of lies, robbery, and endless prey. The crack of whips, the rumble of wheels, the flash of swords fill the streets. She was the mistress of witchcrafts who sold nations through her whoredoms. No fortress will save her, no army will deliver her — all who hear the news of her fall will clap their hands, for who has not felt her endless cruelty?

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| 1 | <i>Woe to the bloody city! it is all full of lies and robbery; the prey departeth not;</i> | Woe to the bloody city! It is all full of lies and robbery; the prey never departs. |
| 2 | <i>The noise of a whip, and the noise of the rattling of the wheels, and of the prancing horses, and of the jumping chariots.</i> | The noise of a whip, the noise of rattling wheels, of prancing horses and bounding chariots! |
| 3 | <i>The horseman lifteth up both the bright sword and the glittering spear: and there is a multitude of slain, and a great number of carcasses; and there is none end of their corpses; they stumble upon their corpses:</i> | The horseman lifts up both the bright sword and the glittering spear. There is a crowd of slain, and a great number of carcasses; there is no end of their corpses; they stumble upon their corpses. |
| 4 | <i>Because of the multitude of the whoredoms of the wellfavoured harlot, the mistress of witchcrafts, that selleth nations through her whoredoms, and families through her witchcrafts.</i> | All because of the multitude of the whoredoms of the well-favored harlot, the mistress of witchcrafts, who sells nations through her whoredoms and families through her witchcrafts. |
| 5 | <i>Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts; and I will discover thy skirts upon thy face, and I will shew the nations thy nakedness, and the kingdoms thy shame.</i> | "I am against You," says the LORD of hosts. "I will uncover Your skirts over Your face; I will show the nations your nakedness and the kingdoms your shame. |

- 6 *And I will cast abominable filth upon thee, and make thee vile, and will set thee as a gazingstock.* I will cast abominable filth on You, and make You vile, and set You as a gazingstock.
- 7 *And it shall come to pass, that all they that look upon thee shall flee from thee, and say, Nineveh is laid waste: who will bemoan her? whence shall I seek comforters for thee?* And it will come to pass that all who look on You will flee from You and say, 'Nineveh is laid waste — who will bemoan her?' From where shall I seek comforters for You?"
- 8 *Art thou better than populous No, that was situate among the rivers, that had the waters round about it, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was from the sea?* Are You better than populous No, that was situated among the rivers, that had the waters round about it, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was from the sea?

■ **NAME NOTE** — **No / populous No (NO)** — The KJV name for Thebes, the ancient capital of Upper Egypt, on the Nile. Famously well-defended by water and walls, it was nevertheless sacked by the Assyrians themselves in 663 BC — the event Nahum cites as an "if it happened to Thebes, it can happen to you" warning to Nineveh.

- 9 *Ethiopia and Egypt were her strength, and it was infinite; Put and Lubim were thy helpers.* Ethiopia and Egypt were her strength, and it was infinite; Put and Lubim were Your helpers.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ethiopia** (ee-thee-OH-pee-uh) — The KJV name for the African kingdom of Cush, south of Egypt along the upper Nile.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Put (PUT)** — An African nation, possibly Libya or part of it; descended from Ham (Gen 10:6).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lubim (LOO-bim)** — The Libyans.

- 10 *Yet was she carried away, she went into captivity: her young children also were dashed in pieces at the top of all the streets: and they cast lots for her honourable men, and all her great men were bound in chains.* Yet she was carried away; she went into captivity. Her young children also were dashed in pieces at the top of all the streets. They cast lots for her honorable men, and all her great men were bound in chains.
- 11 *Thou also shalt be drunken: thou shalt be hid, thou also shalt seek strength because of the enemy.* You also will be drunken; You will be hid; You also will seek strength because of the enemy.

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| <p>12 <i>All thy strong holds shall be like fig trees with the firstripe figs: if they be shaken, they shall even fall into the mouth of the eater.</i></p> | <p>All Your strongholds will be like fig trees with the firstripe figs — if they be shaken, they will even fall into the mouth of the eater.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are women: the gates of thy land shall be set wide open unto thine enemies: the fire shall devour thy bars.</i></p> | <p>See, Your people in the midst of You are women. The gates of Your land will be set wide open to Your enemies; the fire will devour Your bars.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Draw thee waters for the siege, fortify thy strong holds: go into clay, and tread the mortar, make strong the brickkiln.</i></p> | <p>Draw water for the siege; fortify Your strongholds. Go into the clay, tread the mortar, make strong the brickkiln.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>There shall the fire devour thee; the sword shall cut thee off, it shall eat thee up like the cankerworm: make thyself many as the cankerworm, make thyself many as the locusts.</i></p> | <p>There the fire will devour You; the sword will cut You off; it will eat You up like the cankerworm. Make Yourself many as the cankerworm; make Yourself many as the locusts.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Cankerworm** (KANG-ker-worm) — *The KJV name for the locust in one of its destructive growth stages — the young, crawling, voracious form that strips the land before it has wings. KJV uses several distinct words (cankerworm, palmerworm, caterpillar, locust) for what are likely successive stages of the same devouring insect plague.*

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| <p>16 <i>Thou hast multiplied thy merchants above the stars of heaven: the cankerworm spoileth, and fleeth away.</i></p> | <p>You have multiplied Your merchants more than the stars of heaven. The cankerworm strips the land and flies away.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>Thy crowned are as the locusts, and thy captains as the great grasshoppers, which camp in the hedges in the cold day, but when the sun ariseth they flee away, and their place is not known where they are.</i></p> | <p>Your crowned ones are like the locusts, and Your captains like the great grasshoppers that camp in the hedges in the cold day — but when the sun rises, they flee away, and no one knows the place where they are.</p> |

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| <p>18 <i>Thy shepherds slumber, O king of Assyria: thy nobles shall dwell in the dust: thy people is scattered upon the mountains, and no man gathereth them.</i></p> <p>19 <i>There is no healing of thy bruise; thy wound is grievous: all that hear the bruit of thee shall clap the hands over thee: for upon whom hath not thy wickedness passed continually?</i></p> | <p>Your shepherds slumber, O king of Assyria; Your nobles dwell in the dust. Your people are scattered upon the mountains, and no man gathers them.</p> <p>There is no healing of Your bruise; Your wound is grievous. All who hear the bruit of You clap their hands over You — for on whom has Your wickedness not passed continually?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Zeph 3:1-3; Hab 2:12; Ezek 24:6-9; Ezek 22:2-3; Hos 4:2
- v2 — Jer 47:3
- v3 — Hab 3:11; Ezek 39:4
- v4 — Isa 47:9; Isa 47:12-13
- v5 — Jer 13:26; Jer 13:22; Ezek 23:29; Ezek 16:37; Isa 47:2-3
- v6 — Mal 2:9
- v7 — Isa 51:19; Jer 15:5
- v10 — Isa 20:4
- v13 — Jer 51:30; Jer 50:37; Isa 19:16
- v15 — Joel 1:4
- v18 — 1 Kgs 22:17; Ps 76:5-6
- v19 — Mic 1:9; Lam 2:15

Habakkuk

Author: Habakkuk the prophet — he names himself in 1:1 and 3:1. He was very likely a Levitical temple musician, given the musical and liturgical features of chapter 3 ("Shigionoth," "Selah," and the closing dedication "To the chief singer on my stringed instruments").

Date written: c. 612–605 BC — after Assyria's fall and the destruction of Nineveh (612 BC), with Babylon (the Chaldeans) rising rapidly, but before Nebuchadnezzar's first invasion of Judah in 605 BC.

Written to: Judah and Jerusalem — though the book is structured as a dialogue between the prophet and the LORD rather than as a sermon to the people.

Setting: Habakkuk is wrestling with God. He sees the wickedness of Judah — injustice, violence, perverted law, the wicked surrounding the righteous — and asks God how long this will go on. God answers: "Look — I am raising up the Chaldeans, a bitter and hasty nation, to punish you." Habakkuk is more troubled, not less. How can a holy God use a more wicked nation to punish a less wicked one? God answers again: the wicked will not endure; the just shall live by his faith; the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD. The book ends with the prophet's confession of trust — even when the fig tree does not blossom, even when the flock is cut off, "yet will I rejoice in the LORD."

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 612–605 BC under Jehoiakim of Judah, after Nineveh's fall (612 BC) and just before Nebuchadnezzar's first deportation of Judeans to Babylon (605 BC).

Contemporaries: Jeremiah was preaching the same coming Babylonian judgment in Jerusalem, Daniel was about to be deported to Nebuchadnezzar's court, and Zephaniah's recent oracles still echoed in Judah.

Big themes:

- The problem of evil and divine silence — how long will God let wickedness go on?
- God's sovereign use of pagan nations as instruments of judgment
- The certainty of God's holy character even when His ways are mysterious
- The just shall live by his faith — the cornerstone verse of the Reformation
- Woe to the proud and violent — five woes pronounced over the Chaldeans
- The LORD is in His holy temple — silence the only proper response
- Rejoicing in God even when every visible blessing fails

Key passages: Habakkuk 1:2–4 (the prophet's complaint); 1:13 (a holy God who cannot look on iniquity); 2:4 ("the just shall live by his faith"); 2:14 (the earth filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD); 2:20 (let all the earth keep silence); 3:17–19 (the great confession of faith).

How it fits: Habakkuk's "the just shall live by his faith" (2:4) is quoted three times in the New Testament — Romans 1:17, Galatians 3:11, and Hebrews 10:38 — and it is the verse whose

meaning, when grasped by Martin Luther, sparked the Protestant Reformation. It is the Old Testament's clearest single statement of justification by faith. The closing confession (3:17–19) is among the most beloved expressions of faith in trial in all of Scripture.

Chapter 1

Habakkuk cries out to the LORD: "How long shall I cry, and You will not hear?" Violence and wickedness surround him. The LORD answers: He is raising up the Chaldeans — a bitter and swift nation — to execute judgment. Habakkuk is astonished: How can a holy God use a nation more wicked than Judah to punish them?

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| 1 | <i>The burden which Habakkuk the prophet did see.</i> | The burden that Habakkuk the prophet saw. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Habakkuk** (huh-BAK-uk) — "embrace" or "wrestler" — A prophet of Judah, very likely a Levitical temple musician, who wrestled with God in dialogue about evil and divine justice. His name is fitting: he embraces God and wrestles with Him at the same time.

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| 2 | <i>O LORD, how long shall I cry, and thou wilt not hear! even cry out unto thee of violence, and thou wilt not save!</i> | O LORD, how long shall I cry, and You will not hear? I cry out to You of violence, and You will not save. |
| 3 | <i>Why dost thou shew me iniquity, and cause me to behold grievance? for spoiling and violence are before me: and there are that raise up strife and contention.</i> | Why do You show me iniquity, and make me look on grievance? Plundering and violence are before me, and there are those who stir up strife and contention. |
| 4 | <i>Therefore the law is slacked, and judgment doth never go forth: for the wicked doth compass about the righteous; therefore wrong judgment proceedeth.</i> | Therefore the law is slack, and judgment never goes forth. The wicked surround the righteous, so wrong judgment proceeds. |
| 5 | <i>Behold ye among the heathen, and regard, and wonder marvellously: for I will work a work in your days, which ye will not believe, though it be told you.</i> | Look among the heathen, and consider, and be greatly amazed. For I will work a work in your days that you would not believe, even if it were told you. |

- 6 *For, lo, I raise up the Chaldeans, that bitter and hasty nation, which shall march through the breadth of the land, to possess the dwellingplaces that are not theirs.* I am raising up the Chaldeans, that bitter and hasty nation, who march through the breadth of the land to possess dwellings that are not theirs.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Chaldeans** (kal-DEE-uns) — *The Semitic people whose royal house dominated the neo-Babylonian Empire under Nabopolassar and his son Nebuchadnezzar. KJV consistently uses "Chaldeans" — never "Babylonians." They would invade Judah in 605, 597, and 586 BC, finally destroying Jerusalem and the temple.*

- 7 *They are terrible and dreadful: their judgment and their dignity shall proceed of themselves.* They are terrible and dreadful. Their judgment and their dignity proceed from themselves.
- 8 *Their horses also are swifter than the leopards, and are more fierce than the evening wolves: and their horsemen shall spread themselves, and their horsemen shall come from far; they shall fly as the eagle that hasteth to eat.* Their horses are swifter than leopards and fiercer than evening wolves. Their horsemen spread themselves, and their horsemen come from far away. They fly like an eagle that hurries to eat.
- 9 *They shall come all for violence: their faces shall sup up as the east wind, and they shall gather the captivity as the sand.* They all come for violence. Their faces are set like the east wind, and they gather captives like sand.
- 10 *And they shall scoff at the kings, and the princes shall be a scorn unto them: they shall deride every strong hold; for they shall heap dust, and take it.* They scoff at kings, and princes are a scorn to them. They mock every stronghold, for they heap up dust and take it.
- 11 *Then shall his mind change, and he shall pass over, and offend, imputing this his power unto his god.* Then his mind changes, and he passes over and offends, crediting his power to his god.

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| <p>12 <i>Art thou not from everlasting, O LORD my God, mine Holy One? we shall not die. O LORD, thou hast ordained them for judgment; and, O mighty God, thou hast established them for correction.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Thou art of purer eyes than to behold evil, and canst not look on iniquity: wherefore lookest thou upon them that deal treacherously, and holdest thy tongue when the wicked devoureth the man that is more righteous than he?</i></p> <p>14 <i>And makest men as the fishes of the sea, as the creeping things, that have no ruler over them?</i></p> <p>15 <i>They take up all of them with the angle, they catch them in their net, and gather them in their drag: therefore they rejoice and are glad.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Therefore they sacrifice unto their net, and burn incense unto their drag; because by them their portion is fat, and their meat plenteous.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Shall he therefore empty his net, and not spare continually to slay the nations?</i></p> | <p>Are You not from everlasting, O LORD my God, my Holy One? We shall not die. O LORD, You have ordained them for judgment, and, O mighty God, You have established them for correction.</p> <p>You are of purer eyes than to look on evil, and You cannot look on iniquity. Why then do You look on those who deal treacherously, and hold Your tongue when the wicked devours the man more righteous than he?</p> <p>You make men like the fish of the sea, like the creeping things that have no ruler over them.</p> <p>They take all of them up with the hook. They catch them in their net and gather them in their dragnet. Therefore they rejoice and are glad.</p> <p>Therefore they sacrifice to their net and burn incense to their dragnet, because by them their portion is rich and their food plentiful.</p> <p>Shall they therefore empty their net, and continually slay the nations without mercy?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 22:1-2; Ps 13:1-2; Lam 3:8; Jer 14:9; Rev 6:10
- v3 — Ps 55:9-11
- v4 — Ps 119:126; Isa 1:21-23; Job 21:7; Ps 94:20-21; Jer 12:1
- v5 — Acts 13:40-41; Lam 4:12; Isa 29:14; Jer 5:12-13; Jer 9:25-26
- v6 — 2 Kgs 24:2; 2 Chr 36:17; 2 Chr 36:6; Jer 5:15
- v8 — Jer 4:13

v12 — Deut 32:4; Ps 90:2; Jer 46:28; Deut 33:27; Jer 30:11
v13 — Ps 5:4-5; Ps 34:15-16; Jer 12:1-2; Hab 1:3-4; Prov 31:8-9

Chapter 2

Habakkuk stands on his watchtower to wait for the LORD's answer. The LORD replies: "Write the vision and make it plain — the just shall live by his faith." Five woes follow against the arrogant conqueror — for plundering nations, building by bloodshed, filling the earth with violence, shaming his neighbor, and trusting in idols. "The earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea."

1	<i>I will stand upon my watch, and set me upon the tower, and will watch to see what he will say unto me, and what I shall answer when I am reproved.</i>	I will stand on my watch and station myself on the tower. I will watch to see what He will say to me, and what I shall answer when I am reproved.
2	<i>And the LORD answered me, and said, Write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.</i>	The LORD answered me and said, "Write the vision, and make it plain on tablets, so that He who reads it may run.
3	<i>For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.</i>	For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie. Though it waits, wait for it, because it will surely come; it will not delay.
4	<i>Behold, his soul which is lifted up is not upright in him: but the just shall live by his faith.</i>	His soul that is lifted up is not upright in Him, but the just shall live by His faith.
5	<i>Yea also, because he transgresseth by wine, he is a proud man, neither keepeth at home, who enlargeth his desire as hell, and is as death, and cannot be satisfied, but gathereth unto him all nations, and heapeth unto him all people:</i>	Also, because He transgresses by wine, He is a proud man, and He does not stay at home. He enlarges His desire as hell, and is like death, and cannot be satisfied. He gathers all nations to Himself and heaps to Himself all peoples.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell (HELL)** — *The place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant; the abode of the dead. KJV uses one word for what the Hebrew Sheol and Greek Hades/Gehenna name; modern translations sometimes weaken this to "the grave." Here in 2:5 the proud man's appetite is "enlarged as hell" — a bottomless hunger that swallows all and is never satisfied.*

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| <p>6 <i>Shall not all these take up a parable against him, and a taunting proverb against him, and say, Woe to him that increaseth that which is not his! how long? and to him that ladeth himself with thick clay!</i></p> | <p>Shall not all these take up a parable against Him, and a taunting proverb against Him, and say, "Woe to Him who increases what is not His! How long? And to Him who loads Himself with thick clay!"</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Shall they not rise up suddenly that shall bite thee, and awake that shall vex thee, and thou shalt be for booties unto them?</i></p> | <p>Shall they not rise up suddenly who will bite You, and awake who will trouble You? Then You shall become their plunder.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Because thou hast spoiled many nations, all the remnant of the people shall spoil thee; because of men's blood, and for the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.</i></p> | <p>Because You have plundered many nations, all the remnant of the people shall plunder you. This is because of men's blood, and for the violence done to the land, to the city, and to all who live in it.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Woe to him that coveteth an evil covetousness to his house, that he may set his nest on high, that he may be delivered from the power of evil!</i></p> | <p>Woe to Him who covets an evil covetousness for His house, that He may set His nest on high, that He may be delivered from the power of evil!</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Thou hast consulted shame to thy house by cutting off many people, and hast sinned against thy soul.</i></p> | <p>You have brought shame to Your house by cutting off many peoples, and have sinned against Your own soul.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>For the stone shall cry out of the wall, and the beam out of the timber shall answer it.</i></p> | <p>The stone shall cry out from the wall, and the beam from the timber shall answer it.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Woe to him that buildeth a town with blood, and stablisheth a city by iniquity!</i></p> | <p>Woe to Him who builds a town with blood, and establishes a city by iniquity!</p> |

- 13 *Behold, is it not of the LORD of hosts that the people shall labour in the very fire, and the people shall weary themselves for very vanity?* Is it not from the LORD of hosts that the people shall labor in the fire, and the people shall weary themselves for nothing?
- 14 *For the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.* For the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.
- 15 *Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink, that putteth thy bottle to him, and maketh him drunken also, that thou mayest look on their nakedness!* Woe to Him who gives His neighbor drink, who puts His bottle to Him and makes Him drunk also, so that He may look on their nakedness!
- 16 *Thou art filled with shame for glory: drink thou also, and let thy foreskin be uncovered: the cup of the LORD's right hand shall be turned unto thee, and shameful spewing shall be on thy glory.* You are filled with shame instead of glory. Drink also Yourself, and let Your foreskin be uncovered. The cup of the LORD's right hand shall be turned to You, and shameful vomit shall be on Your glory.
- 17 *For the violence of Lebanon shall cover thee, and the spoil of beasts, which made them afraid, because of men's blood, and for the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.* The violence done to Lebanon shall cover You, and the destruction of beasts, which made them afraid, because of men's blood, and for the violence done to the land, to the city, and to all who live in it.
- 18 *What profiteth the graven image that the maker thereof hath graven it; the molten image, and a teacher of lies, that the maker of his work trusteth therein, to make dumb idols?* What profit is the carved image, that its maker has carved it; the molten image, and a teacher of lies, that the maker of His work trusts in it, to make mute idols?
- 19 *Woe unto him that saith to the wood, Awake; to the dumb stone, Arise, it shall teach! Behold, it is laid over with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all in the midst of it.* Woe to Him who says to the wood, "Awake!" — to the mute stone, "Arise, it shall teach!" It is overlaid with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all within it.

- 20

*But the LORD is in his holy temple:
let all the earth keep silence before
him.*
- But the LORD is in His holy temple.
Let all the earth keep silence before
Him.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 21:8; Isa 62:6; 2 Sam 18:24; Ps 85:8; Ps 73:16-17
- v2 — Isa 30:8; Rev 14:13; Rev 1:18-19; Deut 31:22; Rev 21:5-8
- v3 — Ps 27:14; Heb 10:36-37; Ezek 12:25; Lam 3:25-26; Ps 102:13
- v4 — Rom 1:17; Heb 10:38; Gal 3:11-12; Gal 2:16; John 3:36
- v5 — Isa 5:11-12; Prov 27:20; Prov 20:1; Prov 31:4-5
- v11 — Luke 19:40; Josh 24:27; Job 31:38-40; Jas 5:3-4; Gen 4:10
- v12 — Mic 3:10; Dan 4:27-31; Nah 3:1
- v13 — Jer 51:58; Isa 50:11; Prov 21:30
- v14 — Isa 11:9; Ps 22:27; Ps 72:19; Isa 6:3; Ps 86:9
- v18 — Jer 10:8; Isa 44:9-10; Zech 10:2; 1 Cor 12:2; Jer 2:27-28
- v19 — Ps 135:17; Jer 10:4
- v20 — Zech 2:13; Zeph 1:7; Ps 46:10; Ps 11:4; Isa 6:1

Chapter 3

Habakkuk prays in awe, remembering the LORD's mighty works — His glory covers the heavens, pestilence goes before Him, and He marches through the earth in indignation. Though the fig tree does not blossom, the vines fail, and the fields yield no food, yet Habakkuk will rejoice in the LORD and joy in the God of his salvation.

- 1

*A prayer of Habakkuk the prophet
upon Shigionoth.*
- A prayer of Habakkuk the prophet, on
Shigionoth.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Shigionoth* (shig-ee-OH-noth) — A musical or liturgical term in Hebrew; its precise meaning is uncertain. It appears in the title of Psalm 7 (in the singular, Shiggaion) and here in the plural. It likely indicates a passionate, irregular, or wandering style of song — fitting for the wild lyric that follows. Like Selah, it is preserved untranslated.

- 2

*O LORD, I have heard thy speech,
and was afraid: O LORD, revive thy
work in the midst of the years, in the
midst of the years make known; in
wrath remember mercy.*
- O LORD, I have heard Your speech,
and I was afraid. O LORD, revive
Your work in the midst of the years; in
the midst of the years make it known.
In wrath remember mercy.

- 3

God came from Teman, and the Holy One from mount Paran. Selah. His glory covered the heavens, and the earth was full of his praise.
- God came from Teman, and the Holy One from Mount Paran. Selah. His glory covered the heavens, and the earth was full of His praise.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Selah** (SEH-lah) — A musical or liturgical interjection in Hebrew poetry; its meaning is uncertain — possibly "pause," "lift up," or a directive to the temple musicians to play an interlude. It appears throughout the Psalms and three times in this chapter (3:3, 3:9, 3:13). It is preserved untranslated as a feature of the original Hebrew text.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Teman** (TEE-man) — A region of Edom, south of Judah; named for a grandson of Esau (Genesis 36:11). Often paired in Scripture with the wilderness setting of Israel's early encounters with God.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Paran** (PAY-ran) — A mountainous region in the southern Sinai, associated with the giving of the law (Deuteronomy 33:2) and Israel's wilderness wanderings. Habakkuk pictures God advancing from the south, as at Sinai.

- 4

And his brightness was as the light; he had horns coming out of his hand: and there was the hiding of his power.
- His brightness was like the light. He had rays coming out of His hand, and there was the hiding of His power.
- 5

Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet.
- Before Him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at His feet.
- 6

He stood, and measured the earth: he beheld, and drove asunder the nations; and the everlasting mountains were scattered, the perpetual hills did bow: his ways are everlasting.
- He stood and measured the earth. He looked and drove apart the nations. The everlasting mountains were scattered, and the perpetual hills bowed down. His ways are everlasting.
- 7

I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction: and the curtains of the land of Midian did tremble.
- I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction, and the curtains of the land of Midian trembled.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cushan** (KOO-shan) — Likely a tribe of Midian or a region near it; otherwise obscure. Paired here with Midian as a southern people that trembled before the LORD's advance.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Midian** (MID-ee-un) — A nomadic people descended from Abraham through Keturah (Genesis 25:1–2); recalled here for their defeat under Gideon (Judges 7), when the LORD threw their camp into terror.

- 8 *Was the LORD displeased against the rivers? was thine anger against the rivers? was thy wrath against the sea, that thou didst ride upon thine horses and thy chariots of salvation?* Was the LORD displeased with the rivers? Was Your anger against the rivers? Was Your wrath against the sea, that You rode on Your horses and Your chariots of salvation?
- 9 *Thy bow was made quite naked, according to the oaths of the tribes, even thy word. Selah. Thou didst cleave the earth with rivers.* Your bow was made quite bare, according to the oaths of the tribes, even Your word. Selah. You split the earth with rivers.
- 10 *The mountains saw thee, and they trembled: the overflowing of the water passed by: the deep uttered his voice, and lifted up his hands on high.* The mountains saw You and trembled. The overflowing of the water passed by. The deep uttered its voice, and lifted up its hands on high.
- 11 *The sun and moon stood still in their habitation: at the light of thine arrows they went, and at the shining of thy glittering spear.* The sun and moon stood still in their habitation. At the light of Your arrows they went, and at the shining of Your glittering spear.
- 12 *Thou didst march through the land in indignation, thou didst thresh the heathen in anger.* You marched through the land in indignation. You threshed the heathen in anger.
- 13 *Thou wentest forth for the salvation of thy people, even for salvation with thine anointed; thou woundedst the head out of the house of the wicked, by discovering the foundation unto the neck. Selah.* You went forth for the salvation of Your people, for salvation with Your anointed. You wounded the head of the house of the wicked, uncovering the foundation up to the neck. Selah.
- 14 *Thou didst strike through with his staves the head of his villages: they came out as a whirlwind to scatter me: their rejoicing was as to devour the poor secretly.* You struck through with his own staves the head of his villages. They came out like a whirlwind to scatter me. Their rejoicing was as if to devour the poor secretly.
- 15 *Thou didst walk through the sea with thine horses, through the heap of great waters.* You walked through the sea with Your horses, through the heap of great waters.

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| <p>16 <i>When I heard, my belly trembled; my lips quivered at the voice: rottenness entered into my bones, and I trembled in myself, that I might rest in the day of trouble: when he cometh up unto the people, he will invade them with his troops.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Although the fig tree shall not blossom, neither shall fruit be in the vines; the labour of the olive shall fail, and the fields shall yield no meat; the flock shall be cut off from the fold, and there shall be no herd in the stalls:</i></p> <p>18 <i>Yet I will rejoice in the LORD, I will joy in the God of my salvation.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The LORD God is my strength, and he will make my feet like hinds' feet, and he will make me to walk upon mine high places. To the chief singer on my stringed instruments.</i></p> | <p>When I heard, my body trembled. My lips quivered at the voice. Rottenness entered into my bones, and I trembled within myself, that I might rest in the day of trouble. When he comes up against the people, he will invade them with his troops.</p> <p>Although the fig tree shall not blossom, and there shall be no fruit on the vines; though the labor of the olive shall fail, and the fields shall yield no food; though the flock shall be cut off from the fold, and there shall be no herd in the stalls —</p> <p>yet I will rejoice in the LORD; I will joy in the God of my salvation.</p> <p>The Lord GOD is my strength. He will make my feet like hinds' feet, and He will make me to walk on my high places. To the chief singer on my stringed instruments.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ps 85:6; Ps 90:13-17; Hos 6:2-3; Lam 3:32; Isa 51:9-11
- v3 — Deut 33:2; Amos 1:12; Obad 1:9; Ps 4:4
- v4 — Isa 60:19-20; Matt 17:2; Job 26:14; Rev 22:5; Ex 14:20
- v5 — Ex 12:29-30; Num 16:46-49; Ps 78:50-51; Nah 1:2-3; Ps 18:7-13
- v6 — Gen 49:26; Nah 1:5; Deut 33:15; Isa 64:1-3; Isa 51:6
- v8 — Ps 68:17; Deut 33:26-27; Ps 18:10; Ex 14:21-22; Ps 114:5
- v9 — Ps 7:12-13; Ps 105:41; Ps 78:15-16
- v10 — Isa 43:20; Josh 4:23-24; Ps 98:7-8; Ps 93:3; Jer 4:24
- v16 — Jer 23:9; Hab 1:5-11; Dan 10:8; Hab 3:2; Ps 119:120
- v17 — Jer 5:17; Joel 1:16-18; Deut 28:30-41; Hag 2:16-17; Deut 28:15-18
- v18 — Job 13:15; Phil 4:4; Mic 7:7; Isa 61:10; Isa 12:2
- v19 — 2 Sam 22:34; Ps 18:33; Phil 4:13; Ps 46:1; Deut 32:13

Zephaniah

Author: Zephaniah — whose name means "the LORD hides" or "the LORD has hidden." He names himself in 1:1 as the son of Cushi, the great-great-grandson of Hizkiah (Hezekiah) the godly king of Judah. This gives Zephaniah the most distinguished pedigree of any of the writing prophets — he is of royal blood, kin to the kings of Judah.

Date written: c. 640–625 BC, during the reign of Josiah (640–609 BC), king of Judah. The book most likely belongs to the early years of Josiah's reign, before the great reform of 622 BC, since it still describes idolatry rampant in Jerusalem — Baal worship, Malcham, the host of heaven, and the Chemarim priests still serving openly.

Written to: Judah and Jerusalem in the early years of Josiah's reign, with oracles also pronounced against the surrounding nations — Philistia, Moab, Ammon, Ethiopia, and Assyria.

Setting: Judah had spent most of the previous century in deep apostasy under Manasseh and Amon. The young king Josiah was now on the throne. Reform was coming, but it had not yet come. Into this moment Zephaniah preached the great day of the LORD — a day of darkness and thick darkness, a day near and hastening greatly — first against Judah, then against the nations, and finally against all the earth. Yet beyond the judgment lies the surprising final note: a humble remnant gathered to call upon the LORD with one consent, and a singing King in the midst of His people.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 640–625 BC during the early years of Josiah's reign, while Assyria was tottering and Nabopolassar of Babylon was beginning to challenge it for empire.

Contemporaries: Jeremiah was beginning his ministry, Nahum was announcing Nineveh's doom, and the boy-king Josiah was preparing the great reform that would follow the rediscovery of the law in 622 BC.

Big themes:

- The great day of the LORD — dark, near, hastening — a day of wrath, trouble, darkness, and the trumpet
- The universal scope of God's judgment — Judah, the nations, and the whole earth all fall under the same day
- The call to seek the LORD, seek righteousness, seek meekness while the door is still open (2:3)
- The gathering of a poor and humble remnant who trust in the name of the LORD
- The King in the midst of His people — rejoicing over them with joy, resting in His love, rejoicing over them with singing (3:17)
- The conversion of the nations to a pure language calling upon the name of the LORD with one consent (3:9)

Key passages: Zephaniah 1:14–18 (the great day of the LORD); 2:3 (seek the LORD, seek meekness); 3:9 (a pure language); 3:14–17 (the singing King in the midst of His people)

How it fits: Zephaniah is the OT's clearest single oracle on the day of the LORD as a global, cosmic, eschatological day. The book moves in three movements: universal judgment falling first on Judah (ch. 1), then on the surrounding nations (ch. 2), then the final note — a singing King in the midst of a saved and rejoicing remnant (3:14–17). The image of the LORD rejoicing over His own people "with singing" is one of the most stunning portraits of God's affection for His people in all of Scripture. The book that opens with utter desolation closes with the heart of God making music over His redeemed.

Chapter 1

The LORD will utterly sweep away everything from the face of the land — man and beast, birds and fish, the stumbling blocks with the wicked. He will stretch out His hand against Judah and Jerusalem and cut off every remnant of Baal worship. The great day of the LORD is near — a day of wrath, distress, darkness, and alarm. Neither silver nor gold will deliver them.

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| 1 The word of the LORD which came unto Zephaniah the son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hizkiah, in the days of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah. | The word of the LORD that came to Zephaniah the son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hizkiah, in the days of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zephaniah** (zef-uh-NY-uh) — "the LORD hides / has hidden" — A prophet of Judah, great-great-grandson of Hizkiah (Hezekiah); of royal lineage, and the most distinguished pedigree of any writing prophet.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cushi** (KOO-shy) — The father of Zephaniah the prophet. (Not to be confused with the messenger of 2 Samuel 18.)

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hizkiah** (hiz-KY-uh) — KJV variant of Hezekiah; the godly king of Judah (715–686 BC) who trusted the LORD against the Assyrian invasion (2 Kgs 18–19; Isa 36–37); Zephaniah's royal ancestor.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Josiah** (jo-SY-uh) — "the LORD supports" — King of Judah 640–609 BC; ascended the throne at age 8; led the last great reform of Judah's history after the high-priest Hilkiah found the book of the law in the temple (2 Kgs 22–23).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Amon** (AY-mon) — King of Judah 642–640 BC; son of the wicked Manasseh and father of the godly Josiah; assassinated by his own servants after a brief reign of two years (2 Kgs 21:18–26).

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| 2 | I will utterly consume all things from off the land, saith the LORD. | "I will utterly consume all things from off the land," says the LORD. |
| 3 | I will consume man and beast; I will consume the fowls of the heaven, and the fishes of the sea, and the stumblingblocks with the wicked; and I will cut off man from off the land, saith the LORD. | "I will consume man and beast. I will consume the birds of the heavens and the fish of the sea, and the stumbling blocks together with the wicked. I will cut off man from off the land," says the LORD. |
| 4 | I will also stretch out mine hand upon Judah, and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and I will cut off the remnant of Baal from this place, and the name of the Chemarims with the priests; | "I will also stretch out My hand upon Judah, and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem. I will cut off the remnant of Baal from this place, and the name of the Chemarims with the priests, |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Baal** (BAY-al) — "lord, master" — The chief god of the Canaanites; a storm-and-fertility deity whose worship plagued Israel and Judah for centuries. The most persistent rival to the worship of the LORD.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Chemarims** (KEM-ah-rims) — KJV term for the idolatrous black-robed priests of the high places; servants of false gods in Judah. The word appears again at 2 Kings 23:5 and Hosea 10:5.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Chemarims** (KEM-ah-rims) — The KJV's word for the idolatrous priests of Judah's high places. They were the official priests of Baal and the false gods — black-robed servants of the very religions the LORD had commanded Israel to tear down. Josiah would later put them out of office (2 Kgs 23:5).

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| 5 | And them that worship the host of heaven upon the housetops; and them that worship and that swear by the LORD, and that swear by Malcham; | and those who worship the host of heaven upon the housetops, and those who worship and swear by the LORD and yet swear by Malcham, |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Malcham** (MAL-kam) — KJV form of Milcom / Molech; the chief god of the Ammonites, worshiped with child sacrifice (1 Kgs 11:5; 2 Kgs 23:10). The double-worship described here — swearing by the LORD and by Malcham — is the very split-heart idolatry the prophets condemned.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Malcham** — KJV form of Milcom, also called Molech in other passages. The Ammonite god to whom children were burned in the fire — the most savage idolatry of the surrounding nations. Solomon first brought this worship into Jerusalem (1 Kgs 11:5–7), and it festered there for centuries until Josiah destroyed it (2 Kgs 23:10).

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| <p>6 <i>And them that are turned back from the LORD; and those that have not sought the LORD, nor enquired for him.</i></p> | <p>and those who have turned back from the LORD, and those who have not sought the LORD, nor inquired for Him."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Hold thy peace at the presence of the Lord GOD: for the day of the LORD is at hand: for the LORD hath prepared a sacrifice, he hath bid his guests.</i></p> | <p>Hold Your peace at the presence of the Lord GOD, for the day of the LORD is at hand. The LORD has prepared a sacrifice; He has invited His guests.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **The day of the LORD** — A great theme of the prophets, and the central theme of Zephaniah. It is a day fixed by God — a day of His direct action — when He breaks into history to judge sin, vindicate His people, and establish His kingdom. The day has near fulfillments (the fall of Jerusalem in 586 BC, the fall of Nineveh in 612 BC) and a final, cosmic fulfillment yet to come. Zephaniah is the OT's clearest single oracle on this day.

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| <p>8 <i>And it shall come to pass in the day of the LORD's sacrifice, that I will punish the princes, and the king's children, and all such as are clothed with strange apparel.</i></p> | <p>"And it shall come to pass in the day of the LORD's sacrifice, that I will punish the princes and the king's children, and all those who are clothed with strange apparel.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>In the same day also will I punish all those that leap on the threshold, which fill their masters' houses with violence and deceit.</i></p> | <p>In the same day also I will punish all those that leap on the threshold, who fill their masters' houses with violence and deceit.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD, that there shall be the noise of a cry from the fish gate, and an howling from the second, and a great crashing from the hills.</i></p> | <p>And it shall come to pass in that day," says the LORD, "that there shall be the noise of a cry from the fish gate, a howling from the second, and a great crashing from the hills.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>Howl, ye inhabitants of Maktesh, for all the merchant people are cut down; all they that bear silver are cut off.</i></p> | <p>Howl, You inhabitants of Maktesh, for all the merchant people are cut down. All those who bear silver are cut off.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Maktesh** (MAK-tesh) — "mortar" — A quarter of Jerusalem, probably a hollow merchants' district shaped like a mortar bowl. The prophet pictures the merchants pounded as grain is pounded in the bottom of a mortar.

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| <p>12 <i>And it shall come to pass at that time, that I will search Jerusalem with candles, and punish the men that are settled on their lees: that say in their heart, The LORD will not do good, neither will he do evil.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Therefore their goods shall become a booty, and their houses a desolation: they shall also build houses, but not inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, but not drink the wine thereof.</i></p> <p>14 <i>The great day of the LORD is near, it is near, and hasteth greatly, even the voice of the day of the LORD: the mighty man shall cry there bitterly.</i></p> <p>15 <i>That day is a day of wrath, a day of trouble and distress, a day of wasteness and desolation, a day of darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness,</i></p> <p>16 <i>A day of the trumpet and alarm against the fenced cities, and against the high towers.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And I will bring distress upon men, that they shall walk like blind men, because they have sinned against the LORD: and their blood shall be poured out as dust, and their flesh as the dung.</i></p> | <p>And it shall come to pass at that time, that I will search Jerusalem with candles, and punish the men who are settled on their lees, who say in their heart, 'The LORD will not do good, neither will He do evil.'</p> <p>Therefore their goods shall become plunder, and their houses a desolation. They shall also build houses, but not live in them. They shall plant vineyards, but not drink the wine of them.</p> <p>The great day of the LORD is near; it is near and hastens greatly. The voice of the day of the LORD — the mighty man shall cry there bitterly.</p> <p>That day is a day of wrath, a day of trouble and distress, a day of wasteness and desolation, a day of darkness and gloom, a day of clouds and thick darkness,</p> <p>a day of the trumpet and alarm against the fenced cities and against the high towers.</p> <p>"And I will bring distress upon men, so that they shall walk like blind men, because they have sinned against the LORD. Their blood shall be poured out as dust, and their flesh as the dung.</p> |
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- 18 *Neither their silver nor their gold shall be able to deliver them in the day of the LORD's wrath; but the whole land shall be devoured by the fire of his jealousy: for he shall make even a speedy riddance of all them that dwell in the land.* Neither their silver nor their gold shall be able to deliver them in the day of the LORD's wrath. But the whole land shall be devoured by the fire of His jealousy; for He shall make even a speedy riddance of all those who dwell in the land."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 1:2; 2 Chr 34:1-33
 v2 — 2 Kgs 22:16-17; Mic 7:13
 v3 — Hos 4:3
 v5 — Jer 19:13; 2 Kgs 17:33; 1 Kgs 18:21; 2 Kgs 17:41; 2 Kgs 23:12
 v6 — Isa 1:4; Jer 2:13; Jer 15:6; Jer 2:17; Isa 9:13
 v7 — Hab 2:20; Zech 2:13; Zeph 1:14; Jer 46:10; Isa 34:6
 v8 — Isa 24:21
 v10 — 2 Chr 33:14
 v12 — Amos 6:1; Jer 48:11; Ezek 8:12
 v13 — Amos 5:11; Mic 6:15; Deut 28:30
 v14 — Ezek 30:3; Mal 4:5; Zeph 1:7; 1 Thess 4:16; Isa 33:7
 v18 — Zeph 3:8; Ezek 7:19; Prov 11:4; Zeph 1:2-3; Zeph 1:15

Chapter 2

The LORD calls on the humble of the land to seek righteousness and meekness before the day of His anger. He pronounces judgment against the nations: Philistia will be destroyed, Moab and Ammon judged like Sodom and Gomorrah, Ethiopia will fall by the sword, and Assyria will be made desolate — Nineveh a dwelling for wild beasts.

- 1 *Gather yourselves together, yea, gather together, O nation not desired;* Gather yourselves together; gather together, O nation not desired,
- 2 *Before the decree bring forth, before the day pass as the chaff, before the fierce anger of the LORD come upon you, before the day of the LORD's anger come upon you.* before the decree brings forth, before the day passes as the chaff, before the fierce anger of the LORD comes upon You, before the day of the LORD's anger comes upon You.

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| <p>3 <i>Seek ye the LORD, all ye meek of the earth, which have wrought his judgment; seek righteousness, seek meekness: it may be ye shall be hid in the day of the LORD's anger.</i></p> <p>4 <i>For Gaza shall be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation: they shall drive out Ashdod at the noon day, and Ekron shall be rooted up.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Woe unto the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites! the word of the LORD is against you; O Canaan, the land of the Philistines, I will even destroy thee, that there shall be no inhabitant.</i></p> | <p>Seek the LORD, all You meek of the earth, who have wrought His judgment. Seek righteousness; seek meekness. It may be that You shall be hidden in the day of the LORD's anger.</p> <p>For Gaza shall be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation. They shall drive out Ashdod at the noonday, and Ekron shall be rooted up.</p> <p>Woe to the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites! The word of the LORD is against You. O Canaan, the land of the Philistines, I will even destroy You, so that there shall be no inhabitant.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cherethites** (KER-eth-ites) — A Philistine clan or tribe along the coast south of Judah; in the days of David some served in his royal bodyguard (2 Sam 8:18; 15:18). Here they stand for the whole Philistine seaboard under judgment.

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| <p>6 <i>And the sea coast shall be dwellings and cottages for shepherds, and folds for flocks.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And the coast shall be for the remnant of the house of Judah; they shall feed thereupon: in the houses of Ashkelon shall they lie down in the evening: for the LORD their God shall visit them, and turn away their captivity.</i></p> <p>8 <i>I have heard the reproach of Moab, and the revilings of the children of Ammon, whereby they have reproached my people, and magnified themselves against their border.</i></p> | <p>And the sea coast shall be dwellings and cottages for shepherds, and folds for flocks.</p> <p>The coast shall be for the remnant of the house of Judah; they shall feed thereupon. In the houses of Ashkelon they shall lie down in the evening; for the LORD their God shall visit them and turn away their captivity.</p> <p>"I have heard the reproach of Moab, and the revilings of the children of Ammon, by which they have reproached My people and magnified themselves against their border.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Moab** (MOH-ab) — A nation east of the Dead Sea descended from Lot's elder daughter (Gen 19:37); a long-running enemy of Israel.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ammon** (AM-on) — A nation northeast of the Dead Sea, descended from Lot's younger daughter (Gen 19:38); often called in the KJV "the children of Ammon."

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| <p>9 <i>Therefore as I live, saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, Surely Moab shall be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah, even the breeding of nettles, and saltpits, and a perpetual desolation: the residue of my people shall spoil them, and the remnant of my people shall possess them.</i></p> | <p>Therefore as I live," says the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, "surely Moab shall be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah — a breeding of nettles, and saltpits, and a perpetual desolation. The residue of My people shall spoil them, and the remnant of My people shall possess them."</p> |
| <p>10 <i>This shall they have for their pride, because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>This they shall have for their pride, because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of the LORD of hosts.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>The LORD will be terrible unto them: for he will famish all the gods of the earth; and men shall worship him, every one from his place, even all the isles of the heathen.</i></p> | <p>The LORD will be terrible to them, for He will famish all the gods of the earth. And men shall worship Him, every one from his place — even all the isles of the heathen.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Ye Ethiopians also, ye shall be slain by my sword.</i></p> | <p>You Ethiopians also, You shall be slain by My sword.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ethiopians / Cush** (E-thee-OH-pee-uns / KUSH) — The African kingdom south of Egypt, along the upper Nile (modern Sudan and Ethiopia). The KJV consistently translates Cush as "Ethiopia."

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| <p>13 <i>And he will stretch out his hand against the north, and destroy Assyria; and will make Nineveh a desolation, and dry like a wilderness.</i></p> | <p>And He will stretch out His hand against the north and destroy Assyria, and will make Nineveh a desolation, dry like a wilderness.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Assyria** (uh-SEE-ree-uh) — The Mesopotamian empire that had destroyed the northern kingdom of Israel in 722 BC; the dominant world power of the prophet's day, soon to fall.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nineveh** (NIN-eh-veh) — *The capital of the Assyrian empire on the east bank of the Tigris. Once spared in answer to Jonah's preaching, it fell to the Medes and Babylonians in 612 BC, less than thirty years after Zephaniah prophesied its doom.*

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| <p>14 <i>And flocks shall lie down in the midst of her, all the beasts of the nations: both the cormorant and the bittern shall lodge in the upper lintels of it; their voice shall sing in the windows; desolation shall be in the thresholds: for he shall uncover the cedar work.</i></p> <p>15 <i>This is the rejoicing city that dwelt carelessly, that said in her heart, I am, and there is none beside me: how is she become a desolation, a place for beasts to lie down in! every one that passeth by her shall hiss, and wag his hand.</i></p> | <p>And flocks shall lie down in the midst of her, all the beasts of the nations. Both the cormorant and the bittern shall lodge in the upper lintels of it. Their voice shall sing in the windows; desolation shall be in the thresholds; for He shall uncover the cedar work.</p> <p>This is the rejoicing city that dwelt carelessly, that said in her heart, "I am, and there is none beside me." How is she become a desolation, a place for beasts to lie down in! Every one that passes by her shall hiss and wag his hand.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 1:14; 2 Chr 20:4; Neh 9:1; Esth 4:16; Neh 8:1
- v2 — Nah 1:6; Hos 13:3; Isa 17:13; Ps 1:4; Lam 4:11
- v3 — Amos 5:14-15; Isa 26:20-21; Jer 29:12-13; Ps 76:9; Jonah 3:9
- v4 — Zech 9:5-7; Amos 1:6-8; Jer 47:1-7
- v5 — Ezek 25:16; Jer 47:7
- v7 — Ex 4:31; Zeph 3:20; Mic 5:3-8; Luke 1:68; Ezek 39:25
- v9 — Isa 15:1-9; Isa 11:14; Deut 29:23; Isa 25:10
- v10 — Isa 16:6
- v12 — Ezek 30:4-9
- v13 — Nah 3:7
- v15 — Ezek 28:2

Chapter 3

Woe to Jerusalem — the oppressing city that does not obey the LORD. Her princes are roaring lions, her judges are evening wolves, her prophets are treacherous, her priests have profaned the sanctuary. Yet after judgment, the LORD will turn to the peoples a pure language. He will take away the proud and leave a meek and humble remnant. "The LORD your God in your

midst is mighty; He will save, He will rejoice over you with joy, He will rest in His love, He will joy over you with singing."

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| 1 | <i>Woe to her that is filthy and polluted,
to the oppressing city!</i> | Woe to her that is filthy and polluted
— to the oppressing city! |
| 2 | <i>She obeyed not the voice; she received
not correction; she trusted not in the
LORD; she drew not near to her God.</i> | She obeyed not the voice; she received
not correction. She trusted not in the
LORD; she drew not near to her God. |
| 3 | <i>Her princes within her are roaring
lions; her judges are evening wolves;
they gnaw not the bones till the
morrow.</i> | Her princes within her are roaring
lions. Her judges are evening wolves;
they gnaw not the bones till the
morrow. |
| 4 | <i>Her prophets are light and
treacherous persons: her priests have
polluted the sanctuary, they have done
violence to the law.</i> | Her prophets are light and treacherous
persons. Her priests have polluted the
sanctuary; they have done violence to
the law. |
| 5 | <i>The just LORD is in the midst thereof;
he will not do iniquity: every morning
doth he bring his judgment to light, he
faileth not; but the unjust knoweth no
shame.</i> | The just LORD is in the midst of her;
He will not do iniquity. Every morning
He brings His judgment to light; He
fails not. But the unjust knows no
shame. |
| 6 | <i>I have cut off the nations: their towers
are desolate; I made their streets
waste, that none passeth by: their
cities are destroyed, so that there is
no man, that there is none inhabitant.</i> | "I have cut off the nations; their towers
are desolate. I made their streets waste,
so that none passes by. Their cities are
destroyed, so that there is no man, that
there is no inhabitant. |
| 7 | <i>I said, Surely thou wilt fear me, thou
wilt receive instruction; so their
dwelling should not be cut off,
howsoever I punished them: but they
rose early, and corrupted all their
doings.</i> | I said, 'Surely You will fear Me; You
will receive instruction' — so that her
dwelling should not be cut off,
however I punished her. But they rose
early and corrupted all their doings. |

- 8 *Therefore wait ye upon me, saith the LORD, until the day that I rise up to the prey: for my determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms, to pour upon them mine indignation, even all my fierce anger: for all the earth shall be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.* Therefore wait You upon Me," says the LORD, "until the day that I rise up to the prey. For My determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms, to pour upon them My indignation — even all My fierce anger. For all the earth shall be devoured by the fire of My jealousy.
- 9 *For then will I turn to the people a pure language, that they may all call upon the name of the LORD, to serve him with one consent.* For then will I turn to the people a pure language, that they may all call upon the name of the LORD, to serve Him with one consent.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **One consent** — KJV idiom meaning "with one shoulder" — like men shouldering the same yoke together. It is the picture of the nations united in worship of the LORD, every shoulder bent in the same direction. The promise is of a great Gentile turning, when the cleansed peoples speak with a pure language and serve the LORD as one.

- 10 *From beyond the rivers of Ethiopia my suppliants, even the daughter of my dispersed, shall bring mine offering.* From beyond the rivers of Ethiopia My suppliants — even the daughter of My dispersed — shall bring My offering.
- 11 *In that day shalt thou not be ashamed for all thy doings, wherein thou hast transgressed against me: for then I will take away out of the midst of thee them that rejoice in thy pride, and thou shalt no more be haughty because of my holy mountain.* In that day You shall not be ashamed for all Your doings, in which You have transgressed against Me. For then I will take away out of the midst of You those that rejoice in Your pride, and You shall no more be haughty because of My holy mountain.
- 12 *I will also leave in the midst of thee an afflicted and poor people, and they shall trust in the name of the LORD.* I will also leave in the midst of You an afflicted and poor people, and they shall trust in the name of the LORD.

- 13 *The remnant of Israel shall not do iniquity, nor speak lies; neither shall a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth: for they shall feed and lie down, and none shall make them afraid.* The remnant of Israel shall not do iniquity, nor speak lies; nor shall a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth. For they shall feed and lie down, and none shall make them afraid.
- 14 *Sing, O daughter of Zion; shout, O Israel; be glad and rejoice with all the heart, O daughter of Jerusalem.* Sing, O daughter of Zion! Shout, O Israel! Be glad and rejoice with all the heart, O daughter of Jerusalem.
- 15 *The LORD hath taken away thy judgments, he hath cast out thine enemy: the king of Israel, even the LORD, is in the midst of thee: thou shalt not see evil any more.* The LORD has taken away Your judgments; He has cast out Your enemy. The King of Israel, even the LORD, is in the midst of You. You shall not see evil any more.
- 16 *In that day it shall be said to Jerusalem, Fear thou not: and to Zion, Let not thine hands be slack.* In that day it shall be said to Jerusalem, "Fear not!" and to Zion, "Let not Your hands be slack.
- 17 *The LORD thy God in the midst of thee is mighty; he will save, he will rejoice over thee with joy; he will rest in his love, he will joy over thee with singing.* The LORD Your God in the midst of You is mighty. He will save; He will rejoice over You with joy. He will rest in His love; He will joy over You with singing."
- 18 *I will gather them that are sorrowful for the solemn assembly, who are of thee, to whom the reproach of it was a burden.* "I will gather them that are sorrowful for the solemn assembly, who are of You, to whom the reproach of it was a burden.
- 19 *Behold, at that time I will undo all that afflict thee: and I will save her that halteth, and gather her that was driven out; and I will get them praise and fame in every land where they have been put to shame.* At that time I will undo all that afflict You. I will save her that halts and gather her that was driven out. I will get them praise and fame in every land where they have been put to shame.

- 20 *At that time will I bring you again, even in the time that I gather you: for I will make you a name and a praise among all people of the earth, when I turn back your captivity before your eyes, saith the LORD.* At that time will I bring You again, even in the time that I gather You. For I will make You a name and a praise among all people of the earth, when I turn back Your captivity before Your eyes," says the LORD.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Jer 6:6; Isa 30:12; Isa 59:13
v5 — Deut 32:4; Lam 3:23; Ps 145:17; Zeph 3:15; Zeph 3:17
v8 — Joel 3:2; Zeph 1:18; Ps 27:14; Mic 7:7
v9 — Gen 11:1; Ps 22:27; Isa 19:18; Ps 86:9-10; Zech 2:11
v12 — Isa 14:32; Nah 1:7; Isa 61:1-3; Zech 13:8-9
v13 — Rev 14:5; Zeph 2:7; Isa 60:21; Mic 4:7; Mic 4:4
v14 — Isa 12:6; Zech 2:10-11; Mic 4:8; Isa 65:18-19; Ps 95:1-2
v15 — Isa 51:22; Isa 60:18; Zeph 3:5; Isa 40:1-2; Gen 30:23
v16 — Heb 12:12; Isa 35:3-4; Isa 41:10; Eph 3:13
v17 — Ps 149:4; Ps 147:11; Isa 62:4-5; Jer 32:41; Heb 7:25
v19 — Isa 49:25-26; Isa 60:14; Jer 30:16; Zeph 3:15; Mic 7:10
v20 — Jer 29:14; Mal 3:12; Isa 60:15; Isa 56:5; Amos 9:14

Haggai

Author: Haggai the prophet — his name means "festal" or "my feast." He is a post-exilic prophet contemporary with Zechariah; the book is structured around four dated messages he delivered in 520 BC.

Date written: 520 BC — the second year of Darius I of Persia. The book gives precise dates for each of the four messages: Aug 29, Oct 17, Dec 18, and again Dec 18 of that year.

Written to: The returned Jewish exiles in Jerusalem and Judah — especially their civil leader Zerubbabel (the governor) and their religious leader Joshua (the high priest).

Setting: About 16 years before Haggai prophesied, a first wave of Jewish exiles had returned from Babylon under Zerubbabel (538 BC) and begun rebuilding the temple. After laying the foundation, they had stopped — discouraged by opposition, distracted by their own homes, and content to leave God's house in ruins. By 520 BC, drought and economic hardship had set in. Haggai delivers four messages calling the people to "Consider your ways" — to see that their poverty is divine discipline for neglecting God's house — and to rise up and build. Within 23 days the work resumes; within four years the second temple is complete.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied in 520 BC under Darius I of Persia, eighteen years after Cyrus's decree had freed the exiles and only a few decades after the Persians had conquered Babylon.

Contemporaries: Zechariah began prophesying two months after Haggai, while Zerubbabel served as governor of Judah and Joshua as high priest; Ezra and Nehemiah would arrive in Jerusalem in the following generations.

Big themes:

- Covenant priorities — build God's house before paneling your own; what you put first reveals what you truly worship
- Divine providence — "I will shake all nations, and the desire of all nations shall come"
- The greater glory of the latter temple — fulfilled when Christ Himself walked into it
- Zerubbabel as God's chosen signet — the Messianic line preserved through the post-exilic governor of Judah
- The LORD of hosts — the One who stirs the spirit of leaders and people alike to do His work

Key passages: Hag 1:5–7 ("Consider your ways"); 2:6–9 (the desire of all nations and the glory of the latter house); 2:23 (Zerubbabel as signet).

How it fits: Haggai is one of three post-exilic prophets (with Zechariah and Malachi). Together, these three close the OT canon. Haggai is the shortest and most focused — four messages, one purpose: rebuild the temple. The Messianic note in 2:7 ("the desire of all nations") is quoted in Hebrews 12:26–27 as pointing forward to Christ. Zerubbabel appears in the genealogies of Matthew 1:12 and Luke 3:27, preserving the Davidic line through which the Christ would come.

Chapter 1

The returned exiles have built their own paneled houses while the LORD's house lies in ruins. Because of this, the LORD has withheld rain and blessing — they sow much but harvest little. Haggai calls them to go up to the mountain, bring wood, and build the house. Zerubbabel, Joshua, and all the remnant obeyed, and the LORD stirred their spirit to begin the work.

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In the second year of Darius the king, in the sixth month, in the first day of the month, came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet unto Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, saying,
- In the second year of King Darius, in the sixth month, on the first day of the month, the word of the LORD came by Haggai the prophet to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, saying,*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Haggai** (HAG-eye or HAG-ay-eye) — "festal, festive" — A post-exilic prophet of c. 520 BC; otherwise unknown personally. His four dated messages make up this book.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Darius** (duh-RY-us) — Darius I "the Great," king of Persia 522–486 BC; the same Darius who appears in Ezra 5–6 and Daniel 6 (though Darius the Mede in Dan 6 is debated as a different ruler).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zerubbabel** (zeh-RUB-uh-bul) — "seed of Babylon" or "born in Babylon" — Davidic-line governor of post-exilic Judah; led the first wave of returnees from Babylon (Ezra 2:2); rebuilt the foundation of the second temple; God's chosen signet (Hag 2:23); ancestor of Christ (Matt 1:12).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Shealtiel** (sheh-AL-tee-el) — "I have asked of God" — Father of Zerubbabel; son of Jeconiah the captive king (Matt 1:12).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joshua** (JOSH-yoo-uh) — "the LORD saves" — The high priest of the post-exilic restoration (also called "Jeshua" in Ezra-Nehemiah). Featured prominently in the visions of Zechariah 3.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Josedech** (JOS-eh-dek) — KJV "Josedech" (in Ezra-Nehemiah spelled "Jozadak"); the father of Joshua the high priest; carried into Babylon when Jerusalem fell (1 Chr 6:14–15).

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| <p>2 <i>Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, This people say, The time is not come, the time that the LORD's house should be built.</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD of hosts says: "This people say, 'The time has not yet come — the time that the LORD's house should be built.' "</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **LORD of hosts** (LORD of HOSTS) — Hebrew *Yahweh Sabaoth* — "the LORD of armies." A title for God as the Commander of all heavenly and earthly forces; the One who has every host at His disposal. The title appears 14 times in this short book and underscores that the God calling Israel to build is the God who commands every army in heaven and on earth.

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| <p>3 <i>Then came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet, saying,</i></p> | <p>Then the word of the LORD came by Haggai the prophet, saying,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Is it time for you, O ye, to dwell in your cieled houses, and this house lie waste?</i></p> | <p>"Is it time for You yourselves to live in Your paneled houses, while this house lies in ruins?"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Now therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts; Consider your ways.</i></p> | <p>Now therefore this is what the LORD of hosts says: "Consider Your ways.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Ye have sown much, and bring in little; ye eat, but ye have not enough; ye drink, but ye are not filled with drink; ye clothe you, but there is none warm; and he that earneth wages earneth wages to put it into a bag with holes.</i></p> | <p>You have sown much, but bring in little. You eat, but You do not have enough. You drink, but You are not filled. You clothe yourselves, but no one is warm. And he that earns wages earns wages to put them into a bag with holes."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Consider your ways.</i></p> | <p>This is what the LORD of hosts says: "Consider Your ways.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Go up to the mountain, and bring wood, and build the house; and I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified, saith the LORD.</i></p> | <p>Go up to the mountain, bring wood, and build the house. I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified," says the LORD.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Ye looked for much, and, lo, it came to little; and when ye brought it home, I did blow upon it. Why? saith the LORD of hosts. Because of mine house that is waste, and ye run every man unto his own house.</i></p> | <p>"You looked for much, and it came to little. When You brought it home, I blew it away. Why?" says the LORD of hosts. "Because of My house that lies in ruins, while every one of you runs to his own house.</p> |

- 10 *Therefore the heaven over you is stayed from dew, and the earth is stayed from her fruit.* Therefore the heavens over You have withheld their dew, and the earth has withheld its fruit.
- 11 *And I called for a drought upon the land, and upon the mountains, and upon the corn, and upon the new wine, and upon the oil, and upon that which the ground bringeth forth, and upon men, and upon cattle, and upon all the labour of the hands.* I called for a drought on the land, on the mountains, on the corn, on the new wine, on the oil, on whatever the ground brings forth, on men, on cattle, and on all the labor of Your hands."
- 12 *Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed the voice of the LORD their God, and the words of Haggai the prophet, as the LORD their God had sent him, and the people did fear before the LORD.* Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed the voice of the LORD their God and the words of Haggai the prophet, since the LORD their God had sent Him. And the people feared before the LORD.
- 13 *Then spake Haggai the LORD's messenger in the LORD's message unto the people, saying, I am with you, saith the LORD.* Then Haggai, the LORD's messenger, spoke the LORD's message to the people, saying, "I am with you," says the LORD.
- 14 *And the LORD stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and the spirit of all the remnant of the people; and they came and did work in the house of the LORD of hosts, their God,* And the LORD stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and the spirit of all the remnant of the people. They came and worked on the house of the LORD of hosts, their God,
- 15 *In the four and twentieth day of the sixth month, in the second year of Darius the king.* on the twenty-fourth day of the sixth month, in the second year of King Darius.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezra 2:2; Ezra 3:8; Ezra 3:2
v2 — Ezra 4:23-5:2; Neh 4:10
v4 — 2 Sam 7:2; Ps 132:3-5; Phil 2:21; Hag 1:9; Matt 6:33
v5 — Lam 3:40; 2 Cor 13:5; Hag 1:7; Hag 2:15-18
v6 — Hag 1:9; Deut 28:38-40; Hos 4:10; Hos 8:7; Mal 3:9-11
v7 — Ps 119:59-60; Hag 1:5
v8 — Ps 132:13-14; 2 Chr 7:16
v9 — Hag 1:4
v10 — 1 Kgs 8:35; Lev 26:19
v12 — Isa 50:10; Ezra 5:2; Ps 112:1; Hag 1:14
v13 — Isa 43:2; Matt 28:20; Rom 8:31
v14 — 2 Chr 36:22; Heb 13:21; Hag 2:21; Ezra 1:1; Ezra 1:5

Chapter 2

The LORD encourages the builders: though this temple seems as nothing compared to Solomon's, "The desire of all nations shall come, and I will fill this house with glory." The glory of this latter house will be greater than the former. The LORD promises that from this day He will bless them, and He declares Zerubbabel His chosen servant — "I will make you as a signet ring, for I have chosen you."

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| <p>1 <i>In the seventh month, in the one and twentieth day of the month, came the word of the LORD by the prophet Haggai, saying,</i></p> | <p>In the seventh month, on the twenty-first day of the month, the word of the LORD came by the prophet Haggai, saying,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and to the residue of the people, saying,</i></p> | <p>"Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and to the rest of the people, saying,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Who is left among you that saw this house in her first glory? and how do ye see it now? is it not in your eyes in comparison of it as nothing?</i></p> | <p>'Who is left among you that saw this house in its first glory? And how do you see it now? Is it not in your eyes as nothing in comparison?'</p> |

- 4 *Yet now be strong, O Zerubbabel, saith the LORD; and be strong, O Joshua, son of Josedech, the high priest; and be strong, all ye people of the land, saith the LORD, and work: for I am with you, saith the LORD of hosts:* Yet now be strong, O Zerubbabel," says the LORD, "and be strong, O Joshua, son of Josedech, the high priest. Be strong, all You people of the land," says the LORD, "and work. For I am with You," says the LORD of hosts,
- 5 *According to the word that I covenanted with you when ye came out of Egypt, so my spirit remaineth among you: fear ye not.* "according to the word that I covenanted with You when You came out of Egypt. So My Spirit remains among You. Do not fear."
- 6 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts; Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, and the earth, and the sea, and the dry land;* For this is what the LORD of hosts says: "Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, the earth, the sea, and the dry land.
- 7 *And I will shake all nations, and the desire of all nations shall come: and I will fill this house with glory, saith the LORD of hosts.* And I will shake all nations, and the desire of all nations shall come. And I will fill this house with glory," says the LORD of hosts.
- 8 *The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD of hosts.* "The silver is Mine, and the gold is Mine," says the LORD of hosts.
- 9 *The glory of this latter house shall be greater than of the former, saith the LORD of hosts: and in this place will I give peace, saith the LORD of hosts.* "The glory of this latter house shall be greater than that of the former," says the LORD of hosts. "And in this place I will give peace," says the LORD of hosts.
- 10 *In the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet, saying,* On the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came by Haggai the prophet, saying,
- 11 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Ask now the priests concerning the law, saying,* "This is what the LORD of hosts says: 'Ask the priests now concerning the law, saying,

- 12 *If one bear holy flesh in the skirt of his garment, and with his skirt do touch bread, or pottage, or wine, or oil, or any meat, shall it be holy? And the priests answered and said, No.* If a man carries holy flesh in the fold of his garment, and with His fold He touches bread, or stew, or wine, or oil, or any food, shall it become holy?" "And the priests answered and said, "No."
- 13 *Then said Haggai, If one that is unclean by a dead body touch any of these, shall it be unclean? And the priests answered and said, It shall be unclean.* Then Haggai said, "If one who is unclean by a dead body touches any of these, shall it be unclean?" And the priests answered and said, "It shall be unclean."
- 14 *Then answered Haggai, and said, So is this people, and so is this nation before me, saith the LORD; and so is every work of their hands; and that which they offer there is unclean.* Then Haggai answered and said, "So is this people, and so is this nation before Me," says the LORD, "and so is every work of their hands. And what they offer there is unclean."
- 15 *And now, I pray you, consider from this day and upward, from before a stone was laid upon a stone in the temple of the LORD:* And now, I ask You, consider from this day and onward, from before a stone was laid on a stone in the temple of the LORD.
- 16 *Since those days were, when one came to an heap of twenty measures, there were but ten: when one came to the pressfat for to draw out fifty vessels out of the press, there were but twenty.* Since those days were, when one came to a heap of twenty measures, there were only ten. When one came to the winepress to draw out fifty vessels from the press, there were only twenty.
- 17 *I smote you with blasting and with mildew and with hail in all the labours of your hands; yet ye turned not to me, saith the LORD.* I struck You with blight, with mildew, and with hail in all the labors of Your hands; yet You did not turn to Me," says the LORD.
- 18 *Consider now from this day and upward, from the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, even from the day that the foundation of the LORD's temple was laid, consider it.* "Consider now from this day and onward, from the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, from the day that the foundation of the LORD's temple was laid; consider it.

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| <p>19 <i>Is the seed yet in the barn? yea, as yet the vine, and the fig tree, and the pomegranate, and the olive tree, hath not brought forth: from this day will I bless you.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And again the word of the LORD came unto Haggai in the four and twentieth day of the month, saying,</i></p> <p>21 <i>Speak to Zerubbabel, governor of Judah, saying, I will shake the heavens and the earth;</i></p> <p>22 <i>And I will overthrow the throne of kingdoms, and I will destroy the strength of the kingdoms of the heathen; and I will overthrow the chariots, and those that ride in them; and the horses and their riders shall come down, every one by the sword of his brother.</i></p> <p>23 <i>In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, will I take thee, O Zerubbabel, my servant, the son of Shealtiel, saith the LORD, and will make thee as a signet: for I have chosen thee, saith the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>Is the seed still in the barn? Even the vine, the fig tree, the pomegranate, and the olive tree have not yet brought forth. From this day on I will bless You."</p> <p>And again the word of the LORD came to Haggai on the twenty-fourth day of the month, saying,</p> <p>"Speak to Zerubbabel, governor of Judah, saying, 'I will shake the heavens and the earth.</p> <p>And I will overthrow the throne of kingdoms, and I will destroy the strength of the kingdoms of the heathen. I will overthrow the chariots and those who ride in them. The horses and their riders shall come down, every one by the sword of his brother.</p> <p>In that day,' says the LORD of hosts, 'I will take You, O Zerubbabel, My servant, the son of Shealtiel,' says the LORD, 'and will make You as a signet, for I have chosen You,' says the LORD of hosts."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4 — 1 Chr 28:20; Josh 1:9; Deut 31:23; Zech 8:9; 2 Sam 5:10
- v5 — Ex 29:45-46; Isa 41:13; Ex 34:10; Neh 9:20; Zech 8:15
- v6 — Heb 12:26-28; Isa 10:25; Mark 13:24-26; Acts 2:19; Luke 21:25-27
- v7 — Mal 3:1; 1 Kgs 8:11; John 7:37-39
- v8 — Ps 50:10-12; Ps 24:1; Isa 60:17; 1 Chr 29:14-16; Isa 60:13
- v9 — Ps 85:8-9; Col 1:19-21; 2 Cor 3:9-10; Ps 24:7-10; Isa 9:6-7
- v12 — Matt 23:19; Lev 6:27
- v17 — Deut 28:22; Hag 1:11; Hag 1:9

v19 — Mal 3:10; Hab 3:17-18; Prov 3:9-10; Matt 6:33; Gen 26:12

v21 — Zech 4:6-10; Hag 2:6-7

v22 — Mic 5:10; Judg 7:22

v23 — Isa 43:10; Isa 42:1; Jer 22:24; Song 8:6; Zech 4:6-14

Zechariah

Author: Zechariah ("the LORD remembers") the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet (1:1). A post-exilic prophet and almost certainly a priest as well — Iddo is listed among the priests who returned from Babylon with Zerubbabel (Neh 12:4, 16). Zechariah is a contemporary of Haggai and a younger man; his ministry begins two months after Haggai's, and he is described in 2:4 as a "young man."

Date written: c. 520–480 BC. The eight night visions of chapters 1–6 are precisely dated to the second year of Darius the Persian (520 BC). The oracles of chapters 7–8 are dated to the fourth year of Darius (518 BC). Chapters 9–14 are undated and were likely composed several decades later, after the temple was complete and the post-exilic community had matured.

Written to: The returned Jewish exiles in Jerusalem and Judah — especially the two leaders of the restoration, Zerubbabel the governor and Joshua the high priest. Through them, the book speaks to the whole post-exilic remnant, and to the church in every age.

Setting: The same setting as Haggai. The temple foundation has been laid; the work has stalled for sixteen years; Haggai has just begun preaching the people back to work. Two months into Haggai's ministry, Zechariah begins his own. Where Haggai preaches with the urgency of a foreman, Zechariah preaches with the imagery of an apocalyptic seer — eight night visions in a single night (chs. 1–6), then two years of oracles on fasting and the future glory of Zion (chs. 7–8), then late in life, twin oracles of the coming King and the coming Day (chs. 9–14). Zechariah is the most extensively Messianic prophet of the OT after Isaiah.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied from 520 BC into the early decades of the fifth century under Darius I and possibly into the reign of Xerxes I, as the second temple was completed in 516 BC and the Persian empire stretched from Egypt to India.

Contemporaries: Haggai was prophesying alongside him in Jerusalem, Zerubbabel and Joshua led the post-exilic community, and across the empire Daniel had only recently died and Esther's generation was rising.

Big themes:

- God's jealous love for Zion — "I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy" (1:14)
- The cleansing of the high priest as a type of justification — filthy garments removed, fine garments given, iniquity taken away (ch. 3)
- The BRANCH — the Messiah who is both King and Priest, who builds the temple of the LORD (3:8; 6:12–13)
- "Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit, saith the LORD of hosts" (4:6)
- The King coming to Zion lowly, riding on an ass (9:9)
- The betrayal of the Shepherd for thirty pieces of silver, thrown to the potter (11:12–13)
- The mourning over Him whom they have pierced (12:10)

- The smitten Shepherd and the scattered sheep (13:7)
- The Day of the LORD when His feet shall stand on the Mount of Olives (14:4)
- The universal reign of the LORD as King over all the earth (14:9)

Key passages: Zech 1:14–17; 3:8–10; 4:6; 6:12–13; 9:9; 11:12–13; 12:10; 13:1; 13:7; 14:4–9

How it fits: Zechariah is the most Messianic of the Minor Prophets and one of the most Messianic books in the entire OT. It is quoted or alluded to repeatedly in the Passion narratives — the King on a donkey (Matt 21:5; John 12:15), the thirty pieces of silver (Matt 27:9), the potter's field (Matt 27:9–10), the pierced One (John 19:37; Rev 1:7), the smitten Shepherd and scattered sheep (Matt 26:31). It is quoted heavily in the book of Revelation — the four horsemen, the two olive trees, the riders on the horses. Together with Daniel, Zechariah provides the OT framework for NT apocalyptic. The closing chapter (14) is the OT's clearest single picture of the second coming of Christ to the Mount of Olives.

Chapter 1

The LORD calls the people to return to Him, not to be like their fathers who ignored the prophets. Zechariah sees a vision of a man riding a red horse among the myrtle trees — the horsemen report that all the earth sits still and is at rest. The LORD declares He is sore displeased with the nations at ease and will return to Jerusalem with mercies; His house will be rebuilt.

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| 1 In the eighth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet, saying, | In the eighth month of the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came to Zechariah the prophet, son of Berechiah, son of Iddo. He said: |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zechariah** (zek-ah-RYE-ah) — "the LORD remembers" — A post-exilic prophet and priest who ministered alongside Haggai in Jerusalem beginning in 520 BC, in the second year of Darius the Persian. His name itself is the theme of his book: God remembers His covenant, His city, and His promise of Messiah.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Berechiah** (ber-eh-KYE-ah) — "the LORD blesses" — The father of Zechariah, named here to identify the prophet. Christ refers to him in Matt 23:35.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Iddo** (ID-doh) — "timely" or "His witness" — Zechariah's grandfather; one of the priests who returned from Babylon with Zerubbabel (Neh 12:4, 16). This places Zechariah in a priestly line as well as a prophetic one.

■ **WORD NOTE — LORD of hosts** — A title that appears more than 50 times in Zechariah. "Hosts" means "armies" — the heavenly armies of angels and the starry hosts of the sky. The LORD of hosts is God as Commander of all heaven's forces and Ruler of all that He has made. Modern translations that render this "LORD Almighty" lose the military imagery; this version keeps the KJV form throughout.

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| <p>2 <i>The LORD hath been sore displeased with your fathers.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Therefore say thou unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Turn ye unto me, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will turn unto you, saith the LORD of hosts.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Be ye not as your fathers, unto whom the former prophets have cried, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Turn ye now from your evil ways, and from your evil doings: but they did not hear, nor hearken unto me, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Your fathers, where are they? and the prophets, do they live for ever?</i></p> <p>6 <i>But my words and my statutes, which I commanded my servants the prophets, did they not take hold of your fathers? and they returned and said, Like as the LORD of hosts thought to do unto us, according to our ways, and according to our doings, so hath he dealt with us.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Upon the four and twentieth day of the eleventh month, which is the month Sebat, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet, saying,</i></p> | <p>"The LORD was greatly displeased with Your fathers.</p> <p>Therefore say to them, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: Return to Me, says the LORD of hosts, and I will return to You, says the LORD of hosts.'</p> <p>Do not be like Your fathers, to whom the earlier prophets cried out, saying, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: Turn now from Your evil ways and Your evil deeds.' But they would not hear or listen to Me, says the LORD.</p> <p>Where are Your fathers now? And the prophets, do they live forever?</p> <p>But did not My words and My statutes, which I commanded My servants the prophets, take hold of Your fathers? Then they turned back and said, 'Just as the LORD of hosts purposed to do to us, according to our ways and according to our deeds, so has He dealt with us.'"</p> <p>On the twenty-fourth day of the eleventh month, the month of Shebat, in the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came to Zechariah the prophet, son of Berechiah, son of Iddo. He said:</p> |
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- 8 *I saw by night, and behold a man riding upon a red horse, and he stood among the myrtle trees that were in the bottom; and behind him were there red horses, speckled, and white.* I saw in the night a man riding on a red horse. He was standing among the myrtle trees in the valley. Behind Him were red horses, speckled horses, and white horses.
- 9 *Then said I, O my lord, what are these? And the angel that talked with me said unto me, I will shew thee what these be.* Then I said, "My lord, what are these?" The angel who talked with me said, "I will show you what these are."
- 10 *And the man that stood among the myrtle trees answered and said, These are they whom the LORD hath sent to walk to and fro through the earth.* And the man who stood among the myrtle trees answered, "These are the ones whom the LORD has sent to go back and forth through the earth."
- 11 *And they answered the angel of the LORD that stood among the myrtle trees, and said, We have walked to and fro through the earth, and, behold, all the earth sitteth still, and is at rest.* And they answered the angel of the LORD Who stood among the myrtle trees, saying, "We have gone back and forth through the earth, and all the earth sits still and is at rest."

■ **WORD NOTE — The angel of the LORD** — A figure who appears throughout the OT, often speaking and acting as God Himself yet distinguished from the Father. He receives worship that no created angel would receive (Josh 5:14), forgives sin (Ex 23:21), and identifies Himself as God (Ex 3:2–6). Christian tradition has long understood the angel of the LORD to be a pre-incarnate appearance of the Son of God — Christ before His birth in Bethlehem. He appears again and again in Zechariah, both interpreting visions and standing among His people.

- 12 *Then the angel of the LORD answered and said, O LORD of hosts, how long wilt thou not have mercy on Jerusalem and on the cities of Judah, against which thou hast had indignation these threescore and ten years?* Then the angel of the LORD answered, "O LORD of hosts, how long will You not have mercy on Jerusalem and on the cities of Judah, against which You have had indignation these seventy years?"
- 13 *And the LORD answered the angel that talked with me with good words and comfortable words.* And the LORD answered the angel who talked with me with good and comforting words.

- 14 *So the angel that communed with me said unto me, Cry thou, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy.* So the angel who spoke with me said to me, "Cry out, saying, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy.'
- 15 *And I am very sore displeased with the heathen that are at ease: for I was but a little displeased, and they helped forward the affliction.* And I am greatly displeased with the heathen who are at ease. For I was only a little displeased, and they made the affliction worse.
- 16 *Therefore thus saith the LORD; I am returned to Jerusalem with mercies: my house shall be built in it, saith the LORD of hosts, and a line shall be stretched forth upon Jerusalem.* Therefore this is what the LORD says: I have returned to Jerusalem with mercies. My house shall be built in it, says the LORD of hosts, and a measuring line shall be stretched out over Jerusalem.'
- 17 *Cry yet, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; My cities through prosperity shall yet be spread abroad; and the LORD shall yet comfort Zion, and shall yet choose Jerusalem.* Cry out again, saying, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: My cities shall yet overflow with prosperity. The LORD shall yet comfort Zion, and shall yet choose Jerusalem.'
- 18 *Then lifted I up mine eyes, and saw, and behold four horns.* Then I lifted up my eyes and saw, and there were four horns.
- 19 *And I said unto the angel that talked with me, What be these? And he answered me, These are the horns which have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem.* And I said to the angel who talked with me, "What are these?" He answered me, "These are the horns that have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem."
- 20 *And the LORD shewed me four carpenters.* And the LORD showed me four craftsmen.

- 21 *Then said I, What come these to do? And he spake, saying, These are the horns which have scattered Judah, so that no man did lift up his head: but these are come to fray them, to cast out the horns of the Gentiles, which lifted up their horn over the land of Judah to scatter it.* Then I said, "What are these coming to do?" And He said, "These are the horns that scattered Judah, so that no man lifted up His head. But these craftsmen have come to terrify them and to cast out the horns of the Gentiles, which lifted up their horn against the land of Judah to scatter it."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Neh 12:4; Matt 23:35
 v2 — Jer 44:6
 v3 — Jer 3:22; Mal 3:7; Joel 2:12; Deut 30:2-10; Jer 4:1
 v4 — Ps 78:8
 v6 — Lam 2:17; Ezek 12:25-28; Deut 28:15; Matt 24:35; Jer 23:20
 v8 — Rev 6:4
 v10 — Zech 1:11; Zech 6:5-8; Heb 1:14
 v12 — Jer 29:10; Zech 7:5; Ps 74:10; Ps 102:13; Dan 9:2
 v15 — Jer 51:24; Ezek 25:12-17; Isa 54:8
 v16 — Zech 8:3; Ezra 6:14-15; Zech 2:10-11; Ezek 37:24-28
 v17 — Isa 51:3; Zech 2:12
 v21 — Ps 75:10; Lam 2:17; Zech 1:19; Ps 75:4-5

Chapter 2

Zechariah sees a man with a measuring line going to measure Jerusalem. An angel declares that Jerusalem will be inhabited as towns without walls because of the multitude of people and cattle. The LORD Himself will be a wall of fire around her and the glory in her midst. "Sing and rejoice, O daughter of Zion, for I am coming and I will dwell in your midst."

- 1 *I lifted up mine eyes again, and looked, and behold a man with a measuring line in his hand.* I lifted up my eyes again and looked, and there was a man with a measuring line in his hand.
- 2 *Then said I, Whither goest thou? And he said unto me, To measure Jerusalem, to see what is the breadth thereof, and what is the length thereof.* Then I said, "Where are You going?" And He said to me, "To measure Jerusalem, to see how wide it is and how long it is."

- 3 *And, behold, the angel that talked with me went forth, and another angel went out to meet him,* And the angel who talked with me went out, and another angel went out to meet Him,
- 4 *And said unto him, Run, speak to this young man, saying, Jerusalem shall be inhabited as towns without walls for the multitude of men and cattle therein:* and said to Him, "Run, speak to this young man, saying, 'Jerusalem shall be inhabited as towns without walls, because of the great number of men and cattle in it.
- 5 *For I, saith the LORD, will be unto her a wall of fire round about, and will be the glory in the midst of her.* For I, says the LORD, will be a wall of fire all around her, and will be the glory in her midst.'
- 6 *Ho, ho, come forth, and flee from the land of the north, saith the LORD: for I have spread you abroad as the four winds of the heaven, saith the LORD.* Up, up! Come out and flee from the land of the north, says the LORD. For I have spread You abroad as the four winds of heaven, says the LORD.
- 7 *Deliver thyself, O Zion, that dwellest with the daughter of Babylon.* Deliver Yourself, O Zion, You who live with the daughter of Babylon.
- 8 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts; After the glory hath he sent me unto the nations which spoiled you: for he that toucheth you toucheth the apple of his eye.* For this is what the LORD of hosts says: After the glory, He has sent Me to the nations that plundered you. For he who touches you touches the apple of his eye.
- 9 *For, behold, I will shake mine hand upon them, and they shall be a spoil to their servants: and ye shall know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me.* For I will shake My hand against them, and they shall become plunder for their servants. Then You shall know that the LORD of hosts has sent Me.
- 10 *Sing and rejoice, O daughter of Zion: for, lo, I come, and I will dwell in the midst of thee, saith the LORD.* Sing and rejoice, O daughter of Zion. For I am coming, and I will live in your midst, says the LORD.
- 11 *And many nations shall be joined to the LORD in that day, and shall be my people: and I will dwell in the midst of thee, and thou shalt know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me unto thee.* And many nations shall be joined to the LORD in that day, and shall be My people. I will live in Your midst, and You shall know that the LORD of hosts has sent Me to You.

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| 12 | <i>And the LORD shall inherit Judah his portion in the holy land, and shall choose Jerusalem again.</i> | And the LORD shall inherit Judah as His portion in the holy land, and shall again choose Jerusalem. |
| 13 | <i>Be silent, O all flesh, before the LORD: for he is raised up out of his holy habitation.</i> | Be silent, all flesh, before the LORD, for He is roused from His holy dwelling. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 40:3; Zech 1:16; Ezek 47:4; Rev 11:1; Rev 21:15
- v4 — Zech 1:17
- v5 — Isa 4:5; Zech 9:8; Ps 3:3; Isa 60:18-19; Rev 21:23
- v7 — Isa 48:20
- v8 — Ps 17:8; Deut 32:10; John 15:21-23; John 14:26; Ps 105:13-15
- v9 — Isa 19:16
- v10 — Zech 9:9; Matt 28:20; John 1:14; Zech 8:3; Ezek 37:27
- v11 — Rev 11:15; 1 Pet 2:9-10
- v12 — Zech 1:17; Deut 32:9
- v13 — Hab 2:20; Zeph 1:7; Ps 78:65; Ps 68:5; Zeph 3:8

Chapter 3

Zechariah sees Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, with Satan at his right hand to accuse him. The LORD rebukes Satan, strips Joshua's filthy garments, and clothes him with clean robes. The LORD promises to bring forth His servant the BRANCH and to remove the iniquity of the land in one day.

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| 1 | <i>And he shewed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right hand to resist him.</i> | And He showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right hand to resist him. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — *Joshua* (JOSH-yoo-ah) — "the LORD saves" — The high priest of the post-exilic community, son of Jehozadak. The same name in Hebrew as the Joshua who succeeded Moses, and the same name in Hebrew as "Jesus" in the NT. Joshua and Zerubbabel together led the rebuilding of the temple (Ezra 3; Hag 1:1). Here in Zech 3, his cleansing pictures the justification of every sinner.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Satan** (SAY-tan) — "the adversary" or "the accuser" — The chief enemy of God and of God's people; the one who tempted Eve in Eden (Gen 3), accused Job before the throne (Job 1–2), and tempted Christ in the wilderness (Matt 4). Here he accuses Joshua the high priest, and is rebuked by the LORD Himself.

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| <p>2 And the LORD said unto Satan, The LORD rebuke thee, O Satan; even the LORD that hath chosen Jerusalem rebuke thee: is not this a brand plucked out of the fire?</p> | <p>And the LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke You, O Satan! The LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke You! Is this not a brand plucked out of the fire?"</p> |
| <p>3 Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and stood before the angel.</p> | <p>Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and stood before the angel.</p> |
| <p>4 And he answered and spake unto those that stood before him, saying, Take away the filthy garments from him. And unto him he said, Behold, I have caused thine iniquity to pass from thee, and I will clothe thee with change of raiment.</p> | <p>And he answered and said to those who stood before him, "Take away the filthy garments from him." And to him he said, "See, I have taken your iniquity from you, and I will clothe you with a change of clothing."</p> |
| <p>5 And I said, Let them set a fair mitre upon his head. So they set a fair mitre upon his head, and clothed him with garments. And the angel of the LORD stood by.</p> | <p>And I said, "Let them set a clean mitre on His head." So they set a clean mitre on His head and clothed Him with garments. And the angel of the LORD stood by.</p> |
| <p>6 And the angel of the LORD protested unto Joshua, saying,</p> | <p>And the angel of the LORD charged Joshua, saying,</p> |
| <p>7 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; If thou wilt walk in my ways, and if thou wilt keep my charge, then thou shalt also judge my house, and shalt also keep my courts, and I will give thee places to walk among these that stand by.</p> | <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts says: If You will walk in My ways and if You will keep My charge, then You shall also judge My house and also keep My courts. And I will give You places to walk among these who stand by.</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>Hear now, O Joshua the high priest, thou, and thy fellows that sit before thee: for they are men wondered at: for, behold, I will bring forth my servant the BRANCH.</i></p> | <p>Hear now, O Joshua the high priest, you and your fellows who sit before you, for they are men of sign. For I am going to bring forth My servant the BRANCH.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **The BRANCH** — A Messianic title used by Isaiah (Isa 11:1; "a Branch shall grow out of his roots"), Jeremiah (Jer 23:5; 33:15; "a righteous Branch"), and Zechariah (3:8; 6:12). The Hebrew word means a fresh green shoot springing from a cut-down tree — a picture of the Messiah coming from the line of David after the kingdom has been cut down. The KJV preserves it in all-caps as a name; the modern column keeps that exactly. In 6:12 the BRANCH builds the temple of the LORD and is both King and Priest — fulfilled in Jesus Christ.

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| <p>9 <i>For behold the stone that I have laid before Joshua; upon one stone shall be seven eyes: behold, I will engrave the graving thereof, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will remove the iniquity of that land in one day.</i></p> | <p>For see the stone that I have laid before Joshua. On one stone shall be seven eyes. I will engrave its inscription, says the LORD of hosts, and I will remove the iniquity of that land in one day.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, shall ye call every man his neighbour under the vine and under the fig tree.</i></p> | <p>In that day, says the LORD of hosts, every man shall call his neighbor to sit under his vine and under His fig tree."</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 22:31; 1 Pet 5:8; Job 2:1-8; Ps 109:6; Rev 12:9-10
- v2 — Amos 4:11; Jude 1:23; Jude 1:9; Rom 8:33; 1 John 3:8
- v3 — Isa 64:6; Ezra 9:15; Rev 19:8; Rev 7:13-14
- v4 — Luke 15:22; Isa 61:10; Ezek 36:25; Rev 7:14; Isa 43:25
- v5 — Zech 6:11
- v7 — Matt 19:28; Ezek 44:15-16; Gen 26:5; 2 Tim 4:1-2
- v8 — Isa 11:1; Jer 23:5; Zech 6:12; Isa 53:2; Jer 33:15
- v9 — Zech 4:10; Jer 50:20; Rev 5:6; Isa 28:16; Ps 118:22
- v10 — 1 Kgs 4:25; Mic 4:4

Chapter 4

Zechariah sees a golden candlestick with seven lamps and two olive trees on either side. The angel declares to Zerubbabel: "Not by might, nor by power, but by My Spirit, says the LORD of

hosts." *The mountain before Zerubbabel will become a plain, and he will bring forth the headstone with shouts of "Grace, grace to it!" The two olive trees are the two anointed ones who stand before the Lord of the whole earth.*

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| <p>1 <i>And the angel that talked with me came again, and waked me, as a man that is wakened out of his sleep.</i></p> <p>2 <i>And said unto me, What seest thou? And I said, I have looked, and behold a candlestick all of gold, with a bowl upon the top of it, and his seven lamps thereon, and seven pipes to the seven lamps, which are upon the top thereof:</i></p> <p>3 <i>And two olive trees by it, one upon the right side of the bowl, and the other upon the left side thereof.</i></p> <p>4 <i>So I answered and spake to the angel that talked with me, saying, What are these, my lord?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Then the angel that talked with me answered and said unto me, Knowest thou not what these be? And I said, No, my lord.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Then he answered and spake unto me, saying, This is the word of the LORD unto Zerubbabel, saying, Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit, saith the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>And the angel who talked with me came again and woke me, as a man is wakened out of his sleep.</p> <p>And He said to me, "What do You see?" And I said, "I have looked, and there is a candlestick all of gold, with a bowl on the top of it, and its seven lamps on it, with seven pipes to the seven lamps that are on the top of it.</p> <p>And two olive trees are by it, one on the right side of the bowl, and the other on its left side."</p> <p>So I answered and said to the angel who talked with me, "What are these, my lord?"</p> <p>Then the angel who talked with me answered and said to me, "Do You not know what these are?" And I said, "No, my lord."</p> <p>Then He answered and said to me, "This is the word of the LORD to Zerubbabel: Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit, saith the LORD of hosts.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zerubbabel** (zeh-RUB-ah-bel) — "seed of Babylon" or "born in Babylon" — The governor of Judah after the return from exile; a descendant of David through King Jehoiachin, and an ancestor of Christ in both genealogies (Matt 1:12; Luke 3:27). He led the rebuilding of the temple alongside Joshua the high priest. Haggai and Zechariah both addressed prophecies directly to him; in Haggai 2:23 the LORD calls him "My signet ring," a sign of restored Davidic kingship.

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| <p>7 <i>Who art thou, O great mountain?
before Zerubbabel thou shalt become
a plain: and he shall bring forth the
headstone thereof with shoutings,
crying, Grace, grace unto it.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Moreover the word of the LORD came
unto me, saying,</i></p> <p>9 <i>The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the
foundation of this house; his hands
shall also finish it; and thou shalt
know that the LORD of hosts hath sent
me unto you.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For who hath despised the day of
small things? for they shall rejoice,
and shall see the plummet in the hand
of Zerubbabel with those seven; they
are the eyes of the LORD, which run
to and fro through the whole earth.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Then answered I, and said unto him,
What are these two olive trees upon
the right side of the candlestick and
upon the left side thereof?</i></p> <p>12 <i>And I answered again, and said unto
him, What be these two olive branches
which through the two golden pipes
empty the golden oil out of
themselves?</i></p> <p>13 <i>And he answered me and said,
Knowest thou not what these be? And
I said, No, my lord.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then said he, These are the two
anointed ones, that stand by the Lord
of the whole earth.</i></p> | <p>Who are you, O great mountain?
Before Zerubbabel you shall become a
plain. And he shall bring out the
headstone with shouts of, 'Grace, grace
to it!'"</p> <p>Moreover, the word of the LORD
came to me, saying,</p> <p>"The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the
foundation of this house. His hands
shall also finish it. Then You shall
know that the LORD of hosts has sent
Me to You.</p> <p>For who has despised the day of small
things? For they shall rejoice and shall
see the plumb line in the hand of
Zerubbabel with those seven. They are
the eyes of the LORD, which run back
and forth through the whole earth."</p> <p>Then I answered and said to Him,
"What are these two olive trees on the
right side of the candlestick and on its
left side?"</p> <p>And I answered again and said to Him,
"What are these two olive branches
that, through the two golden pipes,
empty the golden oil out of
themselves?"</p> <p>And He answered me and said, "Do
You not know what these are?" And I
said, "No, my lord."</p> <p>Then He said, "These are the two
anointed ones who stand by the Lord
of the whole earth."</p> |
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Cross-References:

- v1** — Dan 8:18; Jer 31:26; Zech 1:9
v2 — Rev 4:5; Rev 1:12; Matt 5:14-16
v3 — Rev 11:4; Rom 11:17; Zech 4:14
v6 — 2 Chr 32:7-8; 2 Cor 10:4-5; 1 Cor 2:4-5; Ps 33:16; Isa 11:2-4
v7 — Jer 51:25; Zech 4:9; Mic 4:1; Ps 118:22; Ps 114:4
v9 — Ezra 6:14-15; Zech 6:12-13
v10 — Job 8:7; 1 Cor 1:28-29; 2 Chr 16:9; Matt 13:31-33; Hag 2:3
v11 — Zech 4:3; Rev 11:4
v13 — Zech 4:5
v14 — Rev 11:4; Isa 61:1-3; Zech 3:1-7; Ex 40:15; Dan 9:24-26

Chapter 5

Zechariah sees a flying scroll — the curse going out over the whole land against every thief and every one who swears falsely. He then sees a woman called Wickedness sitting in a basket, and two women with wings like the wings of a stork carry the basket away to the land of Shinar to build a house for it.

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| 1 | <i>Then I turned, and lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a flying roll.</i> | Then I turned and lifted up my eyes and looked, and there was a flying scroll. |
| 2 | <i>And he said unto me, What seest thou? And I answered, I see a flying roll; the length thereof is twenty cubits, and the breadth thereof ten cubits.</i> | And he said to me, "What do you see?" And I answered, "I see a flying scroll. Its length is twenty cubits, and its width is ten cubits." |
| 3 | <i>Then said he unto me, This is the curse that goeth forth over the face of the whole earth: for every one that stealeth shall be cut off as on this side according to it; and every one that sweareth shall be cut off as on that side according to it.</i> | Then he said to me, "This is the curse that goes out over the face of the whole earth. For everyone who steals shall be cut off according to what is written on this side of it, and everyone who swears falsely shall be cut off according to what is written on the other side. |

- 4 *I will bring it forth, saith the LORD of hosts, and it shall enter into the house of the thief, and into the house of him that sweareth falsely by my name: and it shall remain in the midst of his house, and shall consume it with the timber thereof and the stones thereof.* I will send it out, says the LORD of hosts, and it shall enter the house of the thief and the house of Him who swears falsely by My name. It shall remain in the middle of His house and shall consume it, with its timber and its stones."
- 5 *Then the angel that talked with me went forth, and said unto me, Lift up now thine eyes, and see what is this that goeth forth.* Then the angel who talked with me went out and said to me, "Lift up Your eyes now, and see what is going out."
- 6 *And I said, What is it? And he said, This is an ephah that goeth forth. He said moreover, This is their resemblance through all the earth.* And I said, "What is it?" And He said, "This is an ephah going out." He said further, "This is their appearance throughout the earth."
- 7 *And, behold, there was lifted up a talent of lead: and this is a woman that sitteth in the midst of the ephah.* And a talent of lead was lifted up, and there was a woman sitting inside the ephah."
- 8 *And he said, This is wickedness. And he cast it into the midst of the ephah; and he cast the weight of lead upon the mouth thereof.* And He said, "This is wickedness." And He thrust her back into the middle of the ephah, and threw the lead weight on its mouth.
- 9 *Then lifted I up mine eyes, and looked, and, behold, there came out two women, and the wind was in their wings; for they had wings like the wings of a stork: and they lifted up the ephah between the earth and the heaven.* Then I lifted up my eyes and looked, and two women came out, with the wind in their wings. For they had wings like the wings of a stork. And they lifted up the ephah between earth and heaven.
- 10 *Then said I to the angel that talked with me, Whither do these bear the ephah?* Then I said to the angel who talked with me, "Where are they taking the ephah?"

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| <p>11 <i>And he said unto me, To build it an house in the land of Shinar: and it shall be established, and set there upon her own base.</i></p> | <p>And He said to me, "To build a house for it in the land of Shinar. And when it is ready, it shall be set there on its own base."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Zech 5:2
v3 — Ex 20:15
v4 — Hab 2:9-11; Prov 3:33; Mal 3:5
v6 — Amos 8:5
v7 — Rev 17:1-18
v11 — Gen 11:2; Gen 10:10; Dan 1:2; Isa 11:11; Gen 14:1

Chapter 6

Zechariah sees four chariots with horses of different colors going out from between two mountains of brass — the four spirits of heaven going throughout the earth. The LORD commands Zechariah to make crowns for Joshua the high priest and declare: "The man whose name is the BRANCH shall build the temple of the LORD, and He shall bear the glory and sit and rule on His throne — and He shall be a priest on His throne."

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| <p>1 <i>And I turned, and lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and, behold, there came four chariots out from between two mountains; and the mountains were mountains of brass.</i></p> | <p>And I turned and lifted up my eyes and looked, and four chariots came out from between two mountains. And the mountains were mountains of brass.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>In the first chariot were red horses; and in the second chariot black horses;</i></p> | <p>In the first chariot were red horses, and in the second chariot black horses,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And in the third chariot white horses; and in the fourth chariot grisled and bay horses.</i></p> | <p>and in the third chariot white horses, and in the fourth chariot dappled, strong horses.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Then I answered and said unto the angel that talked with me, What are these, my lord?</i></p> | <p>Then I answered and said to the angel who talked with me, "What are these, my lord?"</p> |

- 5 *And the angel answered and said unto me, These are the four spirits of the heavens, which go forth from standing before the Lord of all the earth.* And the angel answered and said to me, "These are the four spirits of the heavens, going out from standing before the Lord of all the earth.
- 6 *The black horses which are therein go forth into the north country; and the white go forth after them; and the grisled go forth toward the south country.* The chariot with the black horses is going to the north country, the white go out after them, and the dappled go out toward the south country."
- 7 *And the bay went forth, and sought to go that they might walk to and fro through the earth: and he said, Get you hence, walk to and fro through the earth. So they walked to and fro through the earth.* And the strong horses went out, eager to go that they might walk back and forth through the earth. And He said, "Go from here, walk back and forth through the earth." So they walked back and forth through the earth.
- 8 *Then cried he upon me, and spake unto me, saying, Behold, these that go toward the north country have quieted my spirit in the north country.* Then He cried out to me and said, "See, those who go toward the north country have given My Spirit rest in the north country."
- 9 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,* And the word of the LORD came to me, saying,
- 10 *Take of them of the captivity, even of Heldai, of Tobijah, and of Jedaiah, which are come from Babylon, and come thou the same day, and go into the house of Josiah the son of Zephaniah;* "Take a gift from the exiles, from Heldai, from Tobijah, and from Jedaiah, who have come from Babylon. And go the same day to the house of Josiah son of Zephaniah.
- 11 *Then take silver and gold, and make crowns, and set them upon the head of Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest;* Then take silver and gold and make crowns, and set them on the head of Joshua son of Josedech, the high priest.

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| <p>12 <i>And speak unto him, saying, Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, Behold the man whose name is The BRANCH; and he shall grow up out of his place, and he shall build the temple of the LORD:</i></p> <p>13 <i>Even he shall build the temple of the LORD; and he shall bear the glory, and shall sit and rule upon his throne; and he shall be a priest upon his throne: and the counsel of peace shall be between them both.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the crowns shall be to Helem, and to Tobijah, and to Jedaiah, and to Hen the son of Zephaniah, for a memorial in the temple of the LORD.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And they that are far off shall come and build in the temple of the LORD, and ye shall know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me unto you. And this shall come to pass, if ye will diligently obey the voice of the LORD your God.</i></p> | <p>And speak to Him, saying, 'This is what the LORD of hosts says: See the man whose name is The BRANCH. And he shall grow up out of His place, and He shall build the temple of the LORD.</p> <p>Yes, He shall build the temple of the LORD, and He shall bear the glory, and shall sit and rule on His throne. And He shall be a priest on His throne, and the counsel of peace shall be between them both.'</p> <p>And the crowns shall be for Helem, Tobijah, Jedaiah, and Hen son of Zephaniah, as a memorial in the temple of the LORD.</p> <p>And those who are far off shall come and build in the temple of the LORD, and You shall know that the LORD of hosts has sent me to You. And this shall come to pass, if You will diligently obey the voice of the LORD Your God."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eph 1:11; Zech 1:18-19; Dan 8:22; Acts 4:28; Zech 6:5
- v3 — Rev 6:2
- v5 — Heb 1:7; Rev 7:1; Ezek 10:9-19; Ezek 37:9; Ps 104:3-4
- v7 — 2 Chr 16:9; Zech 1:10; Dan 7:19; Dan 7:24; Job 2:1-2
- v8 — Ezek 5:13
- v10 — Ezra 7:14-16
- v11 — Ps 21:3; Zech 3:1; Song 3:11
- v12 — Jer 33:15; Zech 3:8; Isa 11:1; Jer 23:5; Isa 4:2
- v13 — Ps 110:4; Isa 49:5-6; Heb 3:1
- v15 — Isa 60:10

Chapter 7

The people ask whether they should continue fasting as they have done during the seventy years of exile. The LORD replies: "When you fasted, did you really fast for Me?" He calls for true justice, mercy, and compassion — not empty rituals. Their fathers refused to listen and made their hearts like flint, so great wrath came from the LORD of hosts.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass in the fourth year of king Darius, that the word of the LORD came unto Zechariah in the fourth day of the ninth month, even in Chisleu;</i> | And it came to pass in the fourth year of King Darius that the word of the LORD came to Zechariah on the fourth day of the ninth month, the month of Chisleu. |
| 2 | <i>When they had sent unto the house of God Sharezer and Regemmelech, and their men, to pray before the LORD,</i> | When the people had sent Sherezer, Regem-melech, and their men to the house of God to pray before the LORD, |
| 3 | <i>And to speak unto the priests which were in the house of the LORD of hosts, and to the prophets, saying, Should I weep in the fifth month, separating myself, as I have done these so many years?</i> | and to speak to the priests who were in the house of the LORD of hosts and to the prophets, saying, "Should I weep in the fifth month, setting myself apart, as I have done these many years?" |
| 4 | <i>Then came the word of the LORD of hosts unto me, saying,</i> | Then the word of the LORD of hosts came to me, saying, |
| 5 | <i>Speak unto all the people of the land, and to the priests, saying, When ye fasted and mourned in the fifth and seventh month, even those seventy years, did ye at all fast unto me, even to me?</i> | "Speak to all the people of the land and to the priests, saying, 'When You fasted and mourned in the fifth and seventh month, even for those seventy years, did You really fast for Me, even for Me? |
| 6 | <i>And when ye did eat, and when ye did drink, did not ye eat for yourselves, and drink for yourselves?</i> | And when You ate and when You drank, did You not eat for yourselves and drink for yourselves? |

- 7 *Should ye not hear the words which the LORD hath cried by the former prophets, when Jerusalem was inhabited and in prosperity, and the cities thereof round about her, when men inhabited the south and the plain?* Should You not have heard the words which the LORD cried out through the former prophets, when Jerusalem and her surrounding cities were inhabited and prosperous, and the south and the plain were inhabited?"
- 8 *And the word of the LORD came unto Zechariah, saying,* And the word of the LORD came to Zechariah, saying,
- 9 *Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, Execute true judgment, and shew mercy and compassions every man to his brother:* "This is what the LORD of hosts says: Execute true judgment, and show mercy and compassion every man to his brother.
- 10 *And oppress not the widow, nor the fatherless, the stranger, nor the poor; and let none of you imagine evil against his brother in your heart.* Do not oppress the widow or the fatherless, the stranger or the poor. And let none of You devise evil against His brother in Your heart.
- 11 *But they refused to hearken, and pulled away the shoulder, and stopped their ears, that they should not hear.* But they refused to listen, turned a stubborn shoulder, and stopped their ears so they would not hear.
- 12 *Yea, they made their hearts as an adamant stone, lest they should hear the law, and the words which the LORD of hosts hath sent in his spirit by the former prophets: therefore came a great wrath from the LORD of hosts.* They made their hearts hard as flint, so they would not hear the law and the words which the LORD of hosts had sent by His Spirit through the former prophets. Therefore great wrath came from the LORD of hosts.
- 13 *Therefore it is come to pass, that as he cried, and they would not hear; so they cried, and I would not hear, saith the LORD of hosts:* Therefore it has come to pass that as He cried out, and they would not hear, so they cried out, and I would not hear, says the LORD of hosts.

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| 14 <i>But I scattered them with a whirlwind among all the nations whom they knew not. Thus the land was desolate after them, that no man passed through nor returned: for they laid the pleasant land desolate.</i> | But I scattered them with a whirlwind among all the nations whom they did not know. So the land was left desolate after them, with no one passing through or returning. For they laid the pleasant land desolate." |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Zech 8:21
- v3 — Zech 8:19
- v5 — Zech 1:12; Isa 58:4-6
- v6 — 1 Cor 11:20-21
- v7 — Isa 1:16-20; Jer 17:26
- v9 — Mic 6:8; Ps 82:2-4; Prov 21:3; Jer 7:5
- v10 — Jer 5:28
- v11 — Neh 9:29
- v12 — 2 Chr 36:16; Neh 9:29-30; Ezek 11:19; Acts 28:27; Ezek 36:26
- v13 — Prov 1:24-28; Jer 14:12; Isa 1:15; Jer 11:11; Mic 3:4
- v14 — Deut 28:33; Jer 23:19; Deut 28:64

Chapter 8

The LORD declares He is jealous for Zion with great fury. He will return and dwell in Jerusalem, and it will be called the city of truth. Old men and old women will again sit in the streets, and boys and girls will play in them. The fasts of mourning will become feasts of joy. Many peoples and strong nations will come to seek the LORD of hosts in Jerusalem.

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| 1 <i>Again the word of the LORD of hosts came to me, saying,</i> | Again the word of the LORD of hosts came to me, saying, |
| 2 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; I was jealous for Zion with great jealousy, and I was jealous for her with great fury.</i> | "This is what the LORD of hosts says: I was jealous for Zion with great jealousy, and I was jealous for her with great fury. |

- 3 *Thus saith the LORD; I am returned unto Zion, and will dwell in the midst of Jerusalem: and Jerusalem shall be called a city of truth; and the mountain of the LORD of hosts the holy mountain.* This is what the LORD says: I have returned to Zion and will dwell in the midst of Jerusalem. And Jerusalem shall be called the City of Truth, and the mountain of the LORD of hosts the Holy Mountain.
- 4 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; There shall yet old men and old women dwell in the streets of Jerusalem, and every man with his staff in his hand for very age.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: Old men and old women shall yet live in the streets of Jerusalem, every man with his staff in his hand because of his great age.
- 5 *And the streets of the city shall be full of boys and girls playing in the streets thereof.* And the streets of the city shall be full of boys and girls playing in its streets.
- 6 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; If it be marvellous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in these days, should it also be marvellous in mine eyes? saith the LORD of hosts.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: If it is marvelous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in these days, should it also be marvelous in My eyes? says the LORD of hosts.
- 7 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will save my people from the east country, and from the west country;* This is what the LORD of hosts says: I will save My people from the east country and from the west country.
- 8 *And I will bring them, and they shall dwell in the midst of Jerusalem: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God, in truth and in righteousness.* And I will bring them, and they shall live in the midst of Jerusalem. They shall be My people, and I will be their God, in truth and in righteousness.
- 9 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Let your hands be strong, ye that hear in these days these words by the mouth of the prophets, which were in the day that the foundation of the house of the LORD of hosts was laid, that the temple might be built.* This is what the LORD of hosts says: Let Your hands be strong, You who hear in these days these words by the mouth of the prophets, who spoke in the day the foundation of the house of the LORD of hosts was laid, that the temple might be built.

- 10 *For before these days there was no hire for man, nor any hire for beast; neither was there any peace to him that went out or came in because of the affliction: for I set all men every one against his neighbour.* For before these days there were no wages for man, nor any wages for beast. Nor was there any peace for Him who went out or came in, because of the affliction, for I set every man against his neighbor.
- 11 *But now I will not be unto the residue of this people as in the former days, saith the LORD of hosts.* But now I will not be to the remnant of this people as in the former days, says the LORD of hosts.
- 12 *For the seed shall be prosperous; the vine shall give her fruit, and the ground shall give her increase, and the heavens shall give their dew; and I will cause the remnant of this people to possess all these things.* For the seed shall be prosperous, the vine shall give its fruit, and the ground shall give its increase, and the heavens shall give their dew. And I will cause the remnant of this people to possess all these things.
- 13 *And it shall come to pass, that as ye were a curse among the heathen, O house of Judah, and house of Israel; so will I save you, and ye shall be a blessing: fear not, but let your hands be strong.* And it shall come to pass, that as You were a curse among the heathen, O house of Judah and house of Israel, so will I save You, and You shall be a blessing. Do not fear, but let Your hands be strong.
- 14 *For thus saith the LORD of hosts; As I thought to punish you, when your fathers provoked me to wrath, saith the LORD of hosts, and I repented not:* For this is what the LORD of hosts says: As I purposed to punish You when Your fathers provoked Me to wrath, says the LORD of hosts, and I did not relent,
- 15 *So again have I thought in these days to do well unto Jerusalem and to the house of Judah: fear ye not.* so again have I purposed in these days to do good to Jerusalem and to the house of Judah. Do not fear.
- 16 *These are the things that ye shall do; Speak ye every man the truth to his neighbour; execute the judgment of truth and peace in your gates:* These are the things that You shall do: Speak every man the truth to his neighbor; execute the judgment of truth and peace in Your gates.

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| <p>17 <i>And let none of you imagine evil in your hearts against his neighbour; and love no false oath: for all these are things that I hate, saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the word of the LORD of hosts came unto me, saying,</i></p> <p>19 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; The fast of the fourth month, and the fast of the fifth, and the fast of the seventh, and the fast of the tenth, shall be joy and gladness, and cheerful feasts to the house of Judah; therefore love the truth and peace.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; It shall yet come to pass, that there shall come people, and the inhabitants of many cities:</i></p> <p>21 <i>And the inhabitants of one city shall go to another, saying, Let us go speedily to pray before the LORD, and to seek the LORD of hosts: I will go also.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Yea, many people and strong nations shall come to seek the LORD of hosts in Jerusalem, and to pray before the LORD.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Thus saith the LORD of hosts; In those days it shall come to pass, that ten men shall take hold out of all languages of the nations, even shall take hold of the skirt of him that is a Jew, saying, We will go with you: for we have heard that God is with you.</i></p> | <p>And let none of You devise evil in Your hearts against His neighbor, and love no false oath. For all these are things that I hate, says the LORD."</p> <p>And the word of the LORD of hosts came to me, saying,</p> <p>"This is what the LORD of hosts says: The fast of the fourth month, the fast of the fifth, the fast of the seventh, and the fast of the tenth shall be joy and gladness and cheerful feasts to the house of Judah. Therefore love truth and peace.</p> <p>This is what the LORD of hosts says: Peoples shall yet come, and the inhabitants of many cities.</p> <p>And the inhabitants of one city shall go to another, saying, 'Let us go quickly to pray before the LORD and to seek the LORD of hosts. I will go also.'</p> <p>Yes, many peoples and strong nations shall come to seek the LORD of hosts in Jerusalem, and to pray before the LORD.</p> <p>This is what the LORD of hosts says: In those days it shall come to pass that ten men out of all the languages of the nations shall take hold, taking hold of the skirt of a Jew, saying, 'We will go with You, for we have heard that God is with You.'"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v6 — Jer 32:27; Luke 1:37; Luke 18:27; Rom 4:20-21
- v8 — Ezek 36:28; Ezek 11:20; Jer 31:33; Rev 21:3; Jer 4:2
- v12 — Lev 26:4-5; Deut 33:13; Matt 6:33; Gen 27:28; Hag 1:10
- v13 — Zeph 3:20; Ps 72:17; Zech 8:9; Gen 12:2-3; 1 Cor 16:13
- v14 — Ezek 24:14; Jer 31:28
- v15 — Zech 8:13; Mic 7:18-20; Luke 12:32
- v16 — Eph 4:25; Zech 7:9; Ps 15:2; Deut 10:12-13; Luke 3:8-14
- v17 — Prov 6:16-19
- v19 — Zech 8:16; Jer 39:2; Zech 7:3; Zech 7:5; Ps 30:11
- v21 — Zech 7:2; Ps 146:1-2; Hos 6:3
- v22 — Zech 8:21
- v23 — Isa 55:5; 1 Cor 14:25; Isa 60:3; Isa 45:14; Acts 13:47-48

Chapter 9

The LORD pronounces judgment against the surrounding nations — Hadrach, Damascus, Tyre, Sidon, and the Philistine cities. "Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion! Your King is coming to you — righteous and having salvation, lowly and riding upon a donkey." He will speak peace to the heathen, and His dominion will be from sea to sea and from the river to the ends of the earth.

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| 1 <i>The burden of the word of the LORD in the land of Hadrach, and Damascus shall be the rest thereof: when the eyes of man, as of all the tribes of Israel, shall be toward the LORD.</i> | The burden of the word of the LORD against the land of Hadrach, and Damascus shall be its resting place. For the eyes of man, as of all the tribes of Israel, shall be toward the LORD. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hadrach** (HAY-drak) — *An ancient Aramean district north of Damascus, mentioned in Assyrian records but only here in the Bible. Marks the northern starting point of the LORD's sweep of judgment across the lands surrounding Israel.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Damascus** (dah-MAS-kus) — *The ancient capital of Syria (Aram), one of the oldest continuously inhabited cities in the world. The leading city of the northern enemies of Israel throughout the OT period.*

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| 2 <i>And Hamath also shall border thereby; Tyrus, and Zidon, though it be very wise.</i> | And Hamath shall also border on it, as shall Tyrus and Zidon, though they are very wise. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hamath** (HAY-math) — A major Syrian city on the Orontes River, north of Damascus; the traditional northern boundary of Israel's promised territory (Num 13:21; 1 Kings 8:65).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tyrus and Zidon** (TYE-rus, ZYE-don) — The KJV forms of Tyre and Sidon, the two great Phoenician seaports on the Mediterranean coast north of Israel. Famous for wealth, seafaring, and ungodly pride (cf. Ezek 26–28). KJV spelling preserved.

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| <p>3 And Tyrus did build herself a strong hold, and heaped up silver as the dust, and fine gold as the mire of the streets.</p> <p>4 Behold, the Lord will cast her out, and he will smite her power in the sea; and she shall be devoured with fire.</p> <p>5 Ashkelon shall see it, and fear; Gaza also shall see it, and be very sorrowful, and Ekron; for her expectation shall be ashamed; and the king shall perish from Gaza, and Ashkelon shall not be inhabited.</p> | <p>And Tyrus built herself a stronghold, and heaped up silver like dust and fine gold like the mire of the streets.</p> <p>But the Lord will cast her out, and He will strike her power on the sea, and she shall be devoured with fire.</p> <p>Ashkelon shall see it and fear; Gaza also shall see it and be very sorrowful, and Ekron too, for her hope shall be put to shame. The king shall perish from Gaza, and Ashkelon shall not be inhabited.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ekron, Ashkelon, Gaza, Ashdod** — Four of the five chief cities of the Philistines on the southern coastal plain of Palestine. (The fifth, Gath, is not mentioned here.) Long-standing enemies of Israel since the days of the Judges and Samuel.

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| <p>6 And a bastard shall dwell in Ashdod, and I will cut off the pride of the Philistines.</p> <p>7 And I will take away his blood out of his mouth, and his abominations from between his teeth: but he that remaineth, even he, shall be for our God, and he shall be as a governor in Judah, and Ekron as a Jebusite.</p> | <p>And a mongrel people shall live in Ashdod, and I will cut off the pride of the Philistines.</p> <p>And I will take away his blood out of his mouth and his abominations from between his teeth. But he who remains, even he, shall be for our God, and He shall be like a governor in Judah, and Ekron like a Jebusite.</p> |
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| <p>8 <i>And I will encamp about mine house because of the army, because of him that passeth by, and because of him that returneth: and no oppressor shall pass through them any more: for now have I seen with mine eyes.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, thy King cometh unto thee: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim, and the horse from Jerusalem, and the battle bow shall be cut off: and he shall speak peace unto the heathen: and his dominion shall be from sea even to sea, and from the river even to the ends of the earth.</i></p> <p>11 <i>As for thee also, by the blood of thy covenant I have sent forth thy prisoners out of the pit wherein is no water.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Turn you to the strong hold, ye prisoners of hope: even to day do I declare that I will render double unto thee;</i></p> <p>13 <i>When I have bent Judah for me, filled the bow with Ephraim, and raised up thy sons, O Zion, against thy sons, O Greece, and made thee as the sword of a mighty man.</i></p> | <p>And I will encamp around My house because of the army, because of him who passes by and because of him who returns. And no oppressor shall pass through them any more, for now I have seen with My own eyes.</p> <p>Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion! Shout, O daughter of Jerusalem! See, your King cometh unto you: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.</p> <p>And I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim and the horse from Jerusalem, and the battle bow shall be cut off. And He shall speak peace to the heathen. His dominion shall be from sea to sea, and from the River to the ends of the earth.</p> <p>As for you also, by the blood of your covenant I have sent out your prisoners from the pit in which there is no water.</p> <p>Return to the stronghold, you prisoners of hope. Even today I declare that I will give back double to you.</p> <p>For I have bent Judah for Myself, filled the bow with Ephraim, and raised up your sons, O Zion, against your sons, O Greece, and made you like the sword of a mighty man.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Greece** (Grees) — Here, the rising Greek power that would within two centuries conquer the Persian empire under Alexander the Great (333 BC). This is the only place in the OT where Greece is named directly as a future enemy of Israel — fulfilled in the Maccabean wars against the Seleucid Greeks two and a half centuries after Zechariah wrote.

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| <p>14 <i>And the LORD shall be seen over them, and his arrow shall go forth as the lightning: and the Lord GOD shall blow the trumpet, and shall go with whirlwinds of the south.</i></p> <p>15 <i>The LORD of hosts shall defend them; and they shall devour, and subdue with sling stones; and they shall drink, and make a noise as through wine; and they shall be filled like bowls, and as the corners of the altar.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the LORD their God shall save them in that day as the flock of his people: for they shall be as the stones of a crown, lifted up as an ensign upon his land.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For how great is his goodness, and how great is his beauty! corn shall make the young men cheerful, and new wine the maids.</i></p> | <p>And the LORD shall be seen over them, and His arrow shall go out like lightning. And the Lord GOD shall blow the trumpet, and shall go with the whirlwinds of the south.</p> <p>The LORD of hosts shall defend them, and they shall devour and subdue with sling stones. And they shall drink and roar as with wine, and they shall be filled like bowls, like the corners of the altar.</p> <p>And the LORD their God shall save them on that day as the flock of His people. For they shall be like the stones of a crown, lifted up as an ensign over His land.</p> <p>For how great is His goodness, and how great is His beauty! Corn shall make the young men cheerful, and new wine the maids.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Ezek 28:12; Jer 49:23
v4 — Ezek 28:18
v6 — Amos 1:8
v8 — Isa 54:14; Isa 52:1; Isa 60:18; Joel 3:16-17; Jer 31:12
v9 — Matt 21:4-7; Zeph 3:14-15; John 12:13-16; Zech 2:10; Jer 23:5-6
v10 — Hos 1:7; Hos 2:18; 2 Cor 10:4-5
v11 — Isa 51:14; Ex 24:8; Ps 102:19-21; Isa 42:7; Matt 26:28
v12 — Job 42:10; Isa 61:7; Lam 3:21-22; Heb 6:18; Isa 40:2
v14 — Ps 18:14; Isa 66:15

v15 — Zech 12:6; Zech 10:7

v16 — Isa 62:3; Hag 2:23; Luke 12:32; John 10:27; Ps 100:3

v17 — Isa 33:17; 1 John 4:8-11; Isa 62:8-9

Chapter 10

The LORD will give showers of rain — ask Him, not the idols and diviners who speak vanity. The LORD of hosts has visited His flock and will make them as His goodly horse in battle. From Judah will come the cornerstone, the tent peg, and the battle bow. He will strengthen Judah and save Joseph, whistling for them and gathering them, for He has redeemed them.

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| <p>¹ <i>Ask ye of the LORD rain in the time of the latter rain; so the LORD shall make bright clouds, and give them showers of rain, to every one grass in the field.</i></p> | <p>Ask the LORD for rain in the time of the latter rain. So the LORD shall make bright clouds and give them showers of rain, and grass in the field for everyone.</p> |
| <p>² <i>For the idols have spoken vanity, and the diviners have seen a lie, and have told false dreams; they comfort in vain: therefore they went their way as a flock, they were troubled, because there was no shepherd.</i></p> | <p>For the idols have spoken vanity, and the diviners have seen a lie. They have told false dreams; they comfort in vain. Therefore the people went their way like a flock; they were troubled because there was no shepherd.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>Mine anger was kindled against the shepherds, and I punished the goats: for the LORD of hosts hath visited his flock the house of Judah, and hath made them as his goodly horse in the battle.</i></p> | <p>My anger was kindled against the shepherds, and I punished the goats. For the LORD of hosts has visited his flock, the house of Judah, and has made them like His majestic horse in battle.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>Out of him came forth the corner, out of him the nail, out of him the battle bow, out of him every oppressor together.</i></p> | <p>Out of Him came forth the corner, out of Him the nail, out of Him the battle bow, out of Him every ruler together.</p> |
| <p>⁵ <i>And they shall be as mighty men, which tread down their enemies in the mire of the streets in the battle: and they shall fight, because the LORD is with them, and the riders on horses shall be confounded.</i></p> | <p>And they shall be like mighty men who tread down their enemies in the mire of the streets in battle. They shall fight, because the LORD is with them, and the riders on horses shall be put to shame.</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And I will strengthen the house of Judah, and I will save the house of Joseph, and I will bring them again to place them; for I have mercy upon them: and they shall be as though I had not cast them off: for I am the LORD their God, and will hear them.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And they of Ephraim shall be like a mighty man, and their heart shall rejoice as through wine: yea, their children shall see it, and be glad; their heart shall rejoice in the LORD.</i></p> <p>8 <i>I will hiss for them, and gather them; for I have redeemed them: and they shall increase as they have increased.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And I will sow them among the people: and they shall remember me in far countries; and they shall live with their children, and turn again.</i></p> <p>10 <i>I will bring them again also out of the land of Egypt, and gather them out of Assyria; and I will bring them into the land of Gilead and Lebanon; and place shall not be found for them.</i></p> | <p>And I will strengthen the house of Judah, and I will save the house of Joseph. I will bring them back to live in their place again, for I have mercy on them. And they shall be as though I had not cast them off, for I am the LORD their God, and I will hear them.</p> <p>And those of Ephraim shall be like a mighty man, and their heart shall rejoice as with wine. Their children shall see it and be glad; their heart shall rejoice in the LORD.</p> <p>I will whistle for them and gather them, for I have redeemed them. And they shall increase as they have increased before.</p> <p>And I will sow them among the peoples, and they shall remember Me in far countries. They shall live with their children and shall return again.</p> <p>I will also bring them back out of the land of Egypt and gather them out of Assyria. I will bring them into the land of Gilead and Lebanon, and there will not be room enough for them.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lebanon** (LEB-ah-non) — *The mountainous region north of Israel famous for its great cedar trees; Solomon used Lebanon cedar for the temple (1 Kings 5). Here it stands as one of the lands into which the regathered Israelites will spill over.*

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| <p>11 <i>And he shall pass through the sea with affliction, and shall smite the waves in the sea, and all the deeps of the river shall dry up: and the pride of Assyria shall be brought down, and the sceptre of Egypt shall depart away.</i></p> | <p>And He shall pass through the sea of affliction and shall strike the waves of the sea. All the depths of the river shall dry up. The pride of Assyria shall be brought down, and the scepter of Egypt shall pass away.</p> |
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| 12 <i>And I will strengthen them in the LORD; and they shall walk up and down in his name, saith the LORD.</i> | And I will strengthen them in the LORD, and they shall walk up and down in His name, says the LORD. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jas 5:16-18; Isa 44:3; Matt 7:7-8; John 16:23; Jas 5:7
- v2 — Matt 9:36; Jer 27:9
- v3 — Ezek 34:7-10; Ezek 34:2; Ezek 34:16-17; Ezek 34:20-21; Jer 25:34
- v4 — Zech 9:10
- v5 — Hag 2:22
- v6 — Zech 13:9; Zech 10:12; Zeph 3:19-20; Jer 3:18; Isa 41:10
- v8 — Isa 5:26; Isa 7:18
- v9 — Ezek 6:9; Isa 65:23; Neh 1:9
- v11 — Ezek 30:13
- v12 — Isa 41:10; Isa 2:5; Zech 10:6; 2 Tim 2:1; Mic 4:5

Chapter 11

Zechariah acts out a parable as a shepherd of the flock doomed to slaughter. He takes two staffs — Beauty and Bands — and feeds the flock. He is paid thirty pieces of silver, which the LORD tells him to cast to the potter in the house of the LORD. He breaks both staffs: the covenant with the peoples, and the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.

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| 1 <i>Open thy doors, O Lebanon, that the fire may devour thy cedars.</i> | Open Your doors, O Lebanon, that the fire may devour Your cedars. |
| 2 <i>Howl, fir tree; for the cedar is fallen; because the mighty are spoiled: howl, O ye oaks of Bashan; for the forest of the vintage is come down.</i> | Wail, O fir tree, for the cedar has fallen, because the mighty are ruined. Wail, O oaks of Bashan, for the thick forest has come down. |
| 3 <i>There is a voice of the howling of the shepherds; for their glory is spoiled: a voice of the roaring of young lions; for the pride of Jordan is spoiled.</i> | There is the sound of the wailing of the shepherds, for their glory is ruined. There is the sound of the roaring of young lions, for the pride of the Jordan is ruined. |
| 4 <i>Thus saith the LORD my God; Feed the flock of the slaughter;</i> | This is what the LORD my God says: "Feed the flock of the slaughter, |

- 5 *Whose possessors slay them, and hold themselves not guilty: and they that sell them say, Blessed be the LORD; for I am rich: and their own shepherds pity them not.* whose owners slay them and hold themselves not guilty. And those who sell them say, 'Blessed be the LORD, for I am rich!' And their own shepherds do not pity them.
- 6 *For I will no more pity the inhabitants of the land, saith the LORD: but, lo, I will deliver the men every one into his neighbour's hand, and into the hand of his king: and they shall smite the land, and out of their hand I will not deliver them.* For I will no longer pity the inhabitants of the land, says the LORD. But I will deliver every man into his neighbor's hand and into the hand of His king. They shall strike the land, and out of their hand I will not deliver them."
- 7 *And I will feed the flock of slaughter, even you, O poor of the flock. And I took unto me two staves; the one I called Beauty, and the other I called Bands; and I fed the flock.* So I fed the flock of slaughter, in particular the poor of the flock. And I took for myself two staffs. The one I called Beauty, and the other I called Bands. And I fed the flock.
- 8 *Three shepherds also I cut off in one month; and my soul lothed them, and their soul also abhorred me.* And in one month I cut off three shepherds. My soul loathed them, and their soul also abhorred me.
- 9 *Then said I, I will not feed you: that that dieth, let it die; and that that is to be cut off, let it be cut off; and let the rest eat every one the flesh of another.* Then I said, "I will not feed You. Let the one that is dying die, and the one that is to be cut off be cut off. And let the rest eat one another's flesh."
- 10 *And I took my staff, even Beauty, and cut it asunder, that I might break my covenant which I had made with all the people.* And I took my staff Beauty and broke it apart, that I might break my covenant which I had made with all the peoples.
- 11 *And it was broken in that day: and so the poor of the flock that waited upon me knew that it was the word of the LORD.* And it was broken on that day. So the poor of the flock who watched me knew that it was the word of the LORD.

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| <p>12 <i>And I said unto them, If ye think good, give me my price; and if not, forbear. So they weighed for my price thirty pieces of silver.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the LORD said unto me, Cast it unto the potter: a goodly price that I was prised at of them. And I took the thirty pieces of silver, and cast them to the potter in the house of the LORD.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Then I cut asunder mine other staff, even Bands, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the LORD said unto me, Take unto thee yet the instruments of a foolish shepherd.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For, lo, I will raise up a shepherd in the land, which shall not visit those that be cut off, neither shall seek the young one, nor heal that that is broken, nor feed that that standeth still: but he shall eat the flesh of the fat, and tear their claws in pieces.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Woe to the idol shepherd that leaveth the flock! the sword shall be upon his arm, and upon his right eye: his arm shall be clean dried up, and his right eye shall be utterly darkened.</i></p> | <p>And I said to them, "If ye think good, give me my price; and if not, forbear." So they weighed for my price thirty pieces of silver.</p> <p>And the LORD said to me, "Cast it unto the potter: a goodly price that I was prised at of them." And I took the thirty pieces of silver, and cast them to the potter in the house of the LORD.</p> <p>Then I broke apart my other staff, Bands, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.</p> <p>And the LORD said to me, "Take to Yourself again the instruments of a foolish shepherd.</p> <p>For I will raise up a shepherd in the land who shall not care for those that are cut off, nor seek the young one, nor heal the broken, nor feed that which still stands. But He shall eat the flesh of the fat and tear their hooves in pieces.</p> <p>Woe to the worthless shepherd who leaves the flock! The sword shall be on His arm and on His right eye. His arm shall be completely dried up, and His right eye shall be utterly darkened."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v3 — Jer 50:44

v4 — Zech 11:7

v5 — Jer 50:7; 1 Tim 6:5-10

v6 — Jer 13:14

v7 — Zech 11:4; Zech 11:14; Isa 11:4

v8 — John 7:7; John 15:18

v10 — Zech 11:7; Ps 89:39; Jer 14:21; Heb 8:8-13; Jer 31:31-32

v12 — Matt 26:15; Ex 21:32; Luke 22:3-6; Mark 14:10-11; John 13:27-30

v13 — Matt 27:3-10; Acts 1:18-19

v17 — Jer 23:1; Ezek 13:3; 1 Cor 8:4; Ezek 34:2; Isa 42:19-20

Chapter 12

The LORD will make Jerusalem a cup of trembling to all the surrounding peoples and a burdensome stone for all nations — whoever lifts it will be cut to pieces. In that day the LORD will defend Jerusalem. "They shall look upon Me whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for Him as one mourns for an only son."

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| 1 | <i>The burden of the word of the LORD for Israel, saith the LORD, which stretcheth forth the heavens, and layeth the foundation of the earth, and formeth the spirit of man within him.</i> | The burden of the word of the LORD concerning Israel, says the LORD, Who stretches out the heavens and lays the foundation of the earth, and forms the spirit of man within Him: |
| 2 | <i>Behold, I will make Jerusalem a cup of trembling unto all the people round about, when they shall be in the siege both against Judah and against Jerusalem.</i> | "I will make Jerusalem a cup of trembling to all the peoples round about, when they shall be in the siege against both Judah and Jerusalem. |
| 3 | <i>And in that day will I make Jerusalem a burdensome stone for all people: all that burden themselves with it shall be cut in pieces, though all the people of the earth be gathered together against it.</i> | And on that day I will make Jerusalem a heavy stone for all peoples. All who try to lift it shall be cut in pieces, though all the people of the earth be gathered together against it. |
| 4 | <i>In that day, saith the LORD, I will smite every horse with astonishment, and his rider with madness: and I will open mine eyes upon the house of Judah, and will smite every horse of the people with blindness.</i> | On that day, says the LORD, I will strike every horse with terror and its rider with madness. And I will keep My eyes open on the house of Judah, and I will strike every horse of the peoples with blindness. |

- 5 *And the governors of Judah shall say in their heart, The inhabitants of Jerusalem shall be my strength in the LORD of hosts their God.* And the governors of Judah shall say in their heart, 'The inhabitants of Jerusalem shall be my strength in the LORD of hosts their God.'
- 6 *In that day will I make the governors of Judah like an hearth of fire among the wood, and like a torch of fire in a sheaf; and they shall devour all the people round about, on the right hand and on the left: and Jerusalem shall be inhabited again in her own place, even in Jerusalem.* On that day I will make the governors of Judah like a hearth of fire among the wood, and like a torch of fire in a sheaf. And they shall devour all the surrounding peoples on the right and on the left. And Jerusalem shall be inhabited again in her own place, in Jerusalem.
- 7 *The LORD also shall save the tents of Judah first, that the glory of the house of David and the glory of the inhabitants of Jerusalem do not magnify themselves against Judah.* The LORD also shall save the tents of Judah first, so that the glory of the house of David and the glory of the inhabitants of Jerusalem do not magnify themselves above Judah.
- 8 *In that day shall the LORD defend the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and he that is feeble among them at that day shall be as David; and the house of David shall be as God, as the angel of the LORD before them.* On that day the LORD shall defend the inhabitants of Jerusalem. And He who is feeble among them on that day shall be like David, and the house of David shall be like God, like the angel of the LORD before them.
- 9 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will seek to destroy all the nations that come against Jerusalem.* And it shall come to pass on that day that I will seek to destroy all the nations that come against Jerusalem.
- 10 *And I will pour upon the house of David, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the spirit of grace and of supplications: and they shall look upon me whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for him, as one mourneth for his only son, and shall be in bitterness for him, as one that is in bitterness for his firstborn.* And I will pour on the house of David and on the inhabitants of Jerusalem the spirit of grace and of supplications. And they shall look upon me whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for Him, as one mourneth for His only son, and shall be in bitterness for Him, as one that is in bitterness for His firstborn.

- 11

In that day shall there be a great mourning in Jerusalem, as the mourning of Hadadrimmon in the valley of Megiddon.
- On that day there shall be a great mourning in Jerusalem, like the mourning of Hadadrimmon in the valley of Megiddon.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Hadadrimmon** (had-ad-RIM-mon) — A place in the valley of Megiddon, almost certainly named for the death of King Josiah, who was killed in battle there by Pharaoh Necho (2 Kings 23:29; 2 Chron 35:22–25). The mourning for Josiah became a national lament, kept up for generations.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Megiddon** (meh-GID-on) — The KJV form of Megiddo; a strategic fortress city at the pass into the plain of Jezreel. The site of many decisive battles in OT history; the name later becomes "Armageddon" (har-Megiddon, "mountain of Megiddo") in Rev 16:16.

- 12

And the land shall mourn, every family apart; the family of the house of David apart, and their wives apart; the family of the house of Nathan apart, and their wives apart;
- And the land shall mourn, every family by itself: the family of the house of David by itself, and their wives by themselves; the family of the house of Nathan by itself, and their wives by themselves;
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The family of the house of Levi apart, and their wives apart; the family of Shimei apart, and their wives apart;
- the family of the house of Levi by itself, and their wives by themselves; the family of Shimei by itself, and their wives by themselves;
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All the families that remain, every family apart, and their wives apart.
- all the families that remain, every family by itself, and their wives by themselves.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 42:5; Jer 51:15; Isa 57:16; Isa 48:13; Isa 44:24
- v2 — Ps 75:8; Zech 14:14
- v3 — Matt 21:44; Zech 14:2-4; Dan 2:34-35; Luke 20:18
- v4 — Deut 28:28
- v5 — Ps 18:32; Joel 3:16; Zech 10:12
- v8 — Mic 5:2-4
- v9 — Isa 54:17
- v10 — Rev 1:7; Ezek 39:29; John 19:34-37; Joel 2:28-29; Jer 6:26

v11 — 2 Chr 35:24; 2 Kgs 23:29

Chapter 13

On that day a fountain will be opened for sin and for uncleanness. The LORD will cut off the names of the idols and remove the unclean spirit and the false prophets from the land. "Awake, O sword, against My shepherd, against the man that is My fellow" — the shepherd will be struck and the sheep scattered. Two parts will be cut off, but a third will be refined through fire and will call on the LORD's name.

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| <p>1 <i>In that day there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness.</i></p> | <p>On that day a fountain shall be opened to the house of David and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD of hosts, that I will cut off the names of the idols out of the land, and they shall no more be remembered: and also I will cause the prophets and the unclean spirit to pass out of the land.</i></p> | <p>"And it shall come to pass on that day, says the LORD of hosts, that I will cut off the names of the idols out of the land, and they shall no longer be remembered. And I will also cause the prophets and the unclean spirit to pass out of the land.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And it shall come to pass, that when any shall yet prophesy, then his father and his mother that begat him shall say unto him, Thou shalt not live; for thou speakest lies in the name of the LORD: and his father and his mother that begat him shall thrust him through when he prophesieth.</i></p> | <p>And it shall come to pass that when anyone still prophesies, then his father and his mother who gave Him birth shall say to Him, 'You shall not live, for You speak lies in the name of the LORD.' And His father and His mother who gave Him birth shall thrust Him through when He prophesies.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And it shall come to pass in that day, that the prophets shall be ashamed every one of his vision, when he hath prophesied; neither shall they wear a rough garment to deceive:</i></p> | <p>And it shall come to pass on that day that every one of the prophets shall be ashamed of his vision when He has prophesied. Nor shall they wear a rough garment to deceive.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>But he shall say, I am no prophet, I am an husbandman; for man taught me to keep cattle from my youth.</i></p> | <p>But each one shall say, 'I am no prophet; I am a farmer, for a man taught me to keep cattle from my youth.'</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And one shall say unto him, What are these wounds in thine hands? Then he shall answer, Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Awake, O sword, against my shepherd, and against the man that is my fellow, saith the LORD of hosts: smite the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered: and I will turn mine hand upon the little ones.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And it shall come to pass, that in all the land, saith the LORD, two parts therein shall be cut off and die; but the third shall be left therein.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And I will bring the third part through the fire, and will refine them as silver is refined, and will try them as gold is tried: they shall call on my name, and I will hear them: I will say, It is my people: and they shall say, The LORD is my God.</i></p> | <p>And one shall say unto Him, 'What are these wounds in your hands?' Then He shall answer, 'Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends.'</p> <p>"Awake, O sword, against my shepherd, and against the man that is my fellow, saith the LORD of hosts: smite the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered. And I will turn My hand against the little ones.</p> <p>And it shall come to pass that in all the land, says the LORD, two parts in it shall be cut off and die, but the third shall be left in it.</p> <p>And I will bring the third part through the fire, and will refine them as silver is refined, and will test them as gold is tested. They shall call on My name, and I will hear them. I will say, 'It is My people,' and they shall say, 'The LORD is my God.'"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 6:11; John 1:29; Ps 51:2; Ezek 36:25; Heb 9:13-14
- v2 — 1 Kgs 22:22; Jer 23:14-15; Hos 2:17; Ex 23:13; Ezek 36:25
- v3 — Deut 18:20; Deut 13:6-11
- v4 — Mic 3:6-7; Matt 3:4
- v5 — Amos 7:14
- v7 — Mark 14:27; Matt 26:31; John 16:32; Isa 40:11; Mark 14:50
- v8 — Ezek 5:12; Rev 16:19; Ezek 5:2-4; Mal 4:1-3; Rev 8:7-12
- v9 — Ps 50:15; Jer 29:11-12; Acts 2:21; Isa 65:23-24; Isa 48:10

Chapter 14

The day of the LORD comes — all nations gather against Jerusalem, the city is taken, but the LORD goes forth to fight against those nations. His feet will stand on the Mount of Olives, and

it will split in two. Living waters will flow from Jerusalem, and the LORD will be king over all the earth. Every survivor from the nations will go up year by year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, and to keep the feast of tabernacles.

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| <p>1 Behold, the day of the LORD cometh, and thy spoil shall be divided in the midst of thee.</p> | <p>The day of the LORD is coming, and Your plunder shall be divided in Your midst.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **The day of the LORD** — A great theme of the prophets; the appointed day when the LORD brings final judgment on the wicked and final salvation to His people. Sometimes near (the fall of a particular kingdom), sometimes far (the second coming of Christ), and often both at once. Zechariah 14 is the OT's clearest single picture of the day of the LORD at the end of the age, when Christ returns to the Mount of Olives in person.

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| <p>2 For I will gather all nations against Jerusalem to battle; and the city shall be taken, and the houses rifled, and the women ravished; and half of the city shall go forth into captivity, and the residue of the people shall not be cut off from the city.</p> | <p>For I will gather all nations against Jerusalem to battle. The city shall be taken, the houses plundered, and the women ravished. Half of the city shall go out into captivity, but the rest of the people shall not be cut off from the city.</p> |
| <p>3 Then shall the LORD go forth, and fight against those nations, as when he fought in the day of battle.</p> | <p>Then the LORD shall go out and fight against those nations, as He fights in the day of battle.</p> |
| <p>4 And his feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east, and the mount of Olives shall cleave in the midst thereof toward the east and toward the west, and there shall be a very great valley; and half of the mountain shall remove toward the north, and half of it toward the south.</p> | <p>And on that day His feet shall stand upon the mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east. And the mount of Olives shall split in the middle toward the east and toward the west, making a very great valley. Half of the mountain shall move toward the north, and half of it toward the south.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **The mount of Olives** — A ridge running north and south just east of Jerusalem, across the Kidron Valley from the temple mount. The place where David fled from Absalom (2 Sam 15:30), where Ezekiel saw the glory of the LORD depart from the temple (Ezek 11:23), where Christ taught the Olivet discourse (Matt 24), agonized in Gethsemane (Matt 26:36), and from which He ascended into heaven (Acts 1:9–12) — with the promise that He would return to the same place "in like manner" (Acts 1:11). Zech 14:4 is the OT prophecy of that return.

- 5 *And ye shall flee to the valley of the mountains; for the valley of the mountains shall reach unto Azal: yea, ye shall flee, like as ye fled from before the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah: and the LORD my God shall come, and all the saints with thee.* And You shall flee to the valley of the mountains, for the valley of the mountains shall reach unto Azal. Yes, You shall flee, just as You fled from the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah. And the LORD my God shall come, and all the saints with You.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Azal** (AY-zal) — A place east of Jerusalem; the far end of the new valley split open through the Mount of Olives. Mentioned only here in Scripture.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Uzziah** (uh-ZYE-ah) — King of Judah c. 792–740 BC; one of the longer-reigning kings of the southern kingdom (2 Chron 26). The great earthquake "in the days of Uzziah" was so severe it was still remembered two centuries later in Zechariah's day, and Amos dated his prophecy by it (Amos 1:1).

- 6 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that the light shall not be clear, nor dark:* And it shall come to pass on that day that the light shall not be clear, nor dark.
- 7 *But it shall be one day which shall be known to the LORD, not day, nor night: but it shall come to pass, that at evening time it shall be light.* But it shall be one day which shall be known to the LORD, not day, nor night. But it shall come to pass that at evening time it shall be light.
- 8 *And it shall be in that day, that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem; half of them toward the former sea, and half of them toward the hinder sea: in summer and in winter shall it be.* And it shall come to pass on that day that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem, half of them toward the eastern sea, and half of them toward the western sea. In summer and in winter it shall be so.
- 9 *And the LORD shall be king over all the earth: in that day shall there be one LORD, and his name one.* And the LORD shall be king over all the earth: in that day shall there be one LORD, and His name one.

- 10 *All the land shall be turned as a plain from Geba to Rimmon south of Jerusalem: and it shall be lifted up, and inhabited in her place, from Benjamin's gate unto the place of the first gate, unto the corner gate, and from the tower of Hananeel unto the king's winepresses.* All the land shall be turned into a plain from Geba to Rimmon south of Jerusalem. And Jerusalem shall be lifted up and inhabited in her place, from Benjamin's gate to the place of the first gate, to the corner gate, and from the tower of Hananeel to the king's winepresses.
- 11 *And men shall dwell in it, and there shall be no more utter destruction; but Jerusalem shall be safely inhabited.* And men shall live in it, and there shall be no more utter destruction. But Jerusalem shall be safely inhabited.
- 12 *And this shall be the plague wherewith the LORD will smite all the people that have fought against Jerusalem; Their flesh shall consume away while they stand upon their feet, and their eyes shall consume away in their holes, and their tongue shall consume away in their mouth.* And this shall be the plague with which the LORD will strike all the peoples who have fought against Jerusalem. Their flesh shall waste away while they stand on their feet, their eyes shall waste away in their sockets, and their tongue shall waste away in their mouth.
- 13 *And it shall come to pass in that day, that a great tumult from the LORD shall be among them; and they shall lay hold every one on the hand of his neighbour, and his hand shall rise up against the hand of his neighbour.* And it shall come to pass on that day that a great tumult from the LORD shall be among them. They shall each seize the hand of His neighbor, and His hand shall rise up against the hand of His neighbor.
- 14 *And Judah also shall fight at Jerusalem; and the wealth of all the heathen round about shall be gathered together, gold, and silver, and apparel, in great abundance.* And Judah also shall fight at Jerusalem. And the wealth of all the surrounding heathen shall be gathered together — gold, silver, and clothing in great abundance.
- 15 *And so shall be the plague of the horse, of the mule, of the camel, and of the ass, and of all the beasts that shall be in these tents, as this plague.* And so shall be the plague on the horse, the mule, the camel, the ass, and all the animals that shall be in these camps, like this plague.

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| <p>16 <i>And it shall come to pass, that every one that is left of all the nations which came against Jerusalem shall even go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, and to keep the feast of tabernacles.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And it shall be, that whoso will not come up of all the families of the earth unto Jerusalem to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, even upon them shall be no rain.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And if the family of Egypt go not up, and come not, that have no rain; there shall be the plague, wherewith the LORD will smite the heathen that come not up to keep the feast of tabernacles.</i></p> <p>19 <i>This shall be the punishment of Egypt, and the punishment of all nations that come not up to keep the feast of tabernacles.</i></p> <p>20 <i>In that day shall there be upon the bells of the horses, HOLINESS UNTO THE LORD; and the pots in the LORD's house shall be like the bowls before the altar.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Yea, every pot in Jerusalem and in Judah shall be holiness unto the LORD of hosts: and all they that sacrifice shall come and take of them, and seethe therein: and in that day there shall be no more the Canaanite in the house of the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>And it shall come to pass that everyone who is left of all the nations which came against Jerusalem shall go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, and to keep the feast of tabernacles.</p> <p>And it shall be that whoever does not come up of all the families of the earth to Jerusalem to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, on them there shall be no rain.</p> <p>And if the family of Egypt does not go up and come, then they shall have no rain. There shall be the plague with which the LORD will strike the heathen that do not come up to keep the feast of tabernacles.</p> <p>This shall be the punishment of Egypt and the punishment of all nations that do not come up to keep the feast of tabernacles.</p> <p>On that day there shall be inscribed on the bells of the horses, HOLINESS UNTO THE LORD. And the pots in the LORD's house shall be like the bowls before the altar.</p> <p>Yes, every pot in Jerusalem and in Judah shall be holiness unto the LORD of hosts. And all who sacrifice shall come and take of them, and boil in them. And on that day there shall no longer be a Canaanite in the house of the LORD of hosts.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 13:9; Rev 16:14

v2 — Luke 21:20-24; Isa 13:16; Rom 9:27-29; Matt 24:19-22; Mark 13:14

v4 — Mic 1:3-4; Ezek 11:23; Acts 1:11-12; Joel 3:12-14; Zech 14:10

v5 — Jude 1:14-15; Amos 1:1; Matt 25:31; Matt 16:27

v8 — Rev 22:1-2; John 7:38; John 4:14; John 4:10; Rev 7:16-17

v9 — Eph 4:5-6; Rev 11:15; Dan 7:27; Isa 2:2-4; Zeph 3:9

v10 — Josh 15:32; Zech 12:6

v12 — Ezek 39:17-20; Isa 66:15-16

v16 — Isa 66:23; Zech 14:17-19; Isa 66:18-21; Zech 8:20-23; Isa 60:6-9

v17 — Jer 14:4; Isa 60:12; Amos 4:7-8; Rev 11:6; Jas 5:17

v20 — 1 Cor 3:16-17; Ex 39:30

v21 — Ezek 44:9; 1 Cor 10:31; Joel 3:17; Rom 14:6-7; Mark 11:15-17

Malachi

Author: Malachi — whose name means "my messenger." It may be a personal name or a prophetic title for an unnamed prophet; the book gives no biographical data, no genealogy, and no royal date marker.

Date written: c. 460–430 BC, after the second temple has been rebuilt (1:10, 3:1) and the priesthood and tithing system are in operation again. He is contemporary with — or just after — Nehemiah's reforms (Neh 13), rebuking the same generation for the same sins: intermarriage, withholding tithes, and contempt for the temple service.

Written to: The post-exilic Jewish community in Judah — especially the priests (1:6–2:9), who are leading the people in cynicism rather than worship.

Setting: A century after the return from Babylon, the initial fervor has long faded. The temple has been rebuilt for nearly a century but is treated as a chore. The priests are offering blemished animals — the leftovers — and yawning at their service (1:6–14). Men are divorcing their faithful wives to marry pagan women (2:10–16). The people are withholding tithes (3:8–10). They cynically ask, "Where is the God of judgment?" and complain that it is vain to serve God (2:17, 3:14). Malachi confronts these sins with the same disputation pattern eight times over: God states a charge; the people protest, "Wherein?"; God answers. The book closes with the promise of the coming Day of the LORD — preceded by the return of Elijah — when the wicked shall be ashes under the soles of the feet of the righteous, and the Sun of righteousness shall arise with healing in His wings.

Where this sits historically: Prophesied c. 460–430 BC under Persian rule (Artaxerxes I), alongside or just after Nehemiah's reforms, and a century after Cyrus had first let the exiles return.

Contemporaries: Nehemiah was governing Jerusalem and confronting the same sins of intermarriage and tithe-neglect, and Ezra had recently led his own reforms; after Malachi the OT prophetic voice falls silent for four hundred years.

Big themes:

- God's covenant love for Jacob over Esau — the bedrock answer to "Wherein hast thou loved us?"
- The LORD's hatred of profaned worship and blemished offerings — half-hearted religion offends Him more than no religion at all
- The LORD hates putting away — He is the witness of the marriage covenant and detests faithless divorce
- The cynicism of "It is vain to serve God" — and the LORD's answer: a book of remembrance, and a day when the righteous shall be discerned from the wicked
- The promised messenger preparing the way of the Lord (3:1) — fulfilled in John the Baptist
- The great and dreadful day of the LORD — burning as an oven for the wicked, healing in His wings for those who fear His name

- The promise of Elijah's return (4:5–6) — fulfilled in John the Baptist per our Lord's own word (Matt 11:14, 17:12–13)

Key passages: Mal 1:2 (Jacob have I loved); 2:16 (he hateth putting away); 3:1 (My messenger); 3:6 (I am the LORD, I change not); 3:10 (windows of heaven and tithes); 4:2 (Sun of righteousness); 4:5–6 (Elijah)

How it fits: Malachi is the last book of the Old Testament, closing the canon with two great promises: the messenger who will prepare the way (3:1), and the Elijah who will come before the great and dreadful day (4:5–6). After Malachi, four hundred silent years pass before the angel Gabriel speaks to Zacharias in Luke 1 about the birth of John the Baptist — the very messenger Malachi foretold. The last image of the OT is the Sun of righteousness arising with healing in His wings — the last Messianic picture before the New Testament itself begins.

Chapter 1

"I have loved you," says the LORD — yet Israel asks, "How have You loved us?" The LORD points to His choice of Jacob over Esau. The priests dishonor His name by offering polluted bread, blind and lame animals on His altar. "From the rising of the sun to its going down, My name shall be great among the heathen," but Israel has profaned it.

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| 1 <i>The burden of the word of the LORD to Israel by Malachi.</i> | The burden of the word of the LORD to Israel by Malachi. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Malachi** (MAL-uh-kye) — "my messenger" — Possibly a personal name; possibly a title for an unnamed prophet writing under his prophetic designation. The last canonical prophet of the Old Testament.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **LORD of hosts** (LORD of HOHSTS) — A divine title used by Malachi twenty-four times in just four chapters. "Hosts" means armies — the angelic armies of heaven and the starry hosts above. The title declares that the LORD commands every power in heaven and earth. He is not a local or limited God; He is the Commander of every army that exists.

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| 2 <i>I have loved you, saith the LORD. Yet ye say, Wherein hast thou loved us? Was not Esau Jacob's brother? saith the LORD: yet I loved Jacob,</i> | "I have loved You," says the LORD. Yet You say, "In what way have You loved us?" "Was not Esau Jacob's brother?" says the LORD. "Yet I loved Jacob, |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Esau** (EE-saw) — "hairy" — Jacob's twin brother; father of the Edomites. The Old Testament's standing symbol of profane indifference to spiritual blessing — he sold his birthright for a single meal (Heb 12:16–17).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jacob** (JAY-kub) — "supplanter" — Esau's twin brother; father of the twelve tribes of Israel. The Old Testament's standing symbol of God's electing love. Paul quotes this very verse in Romans 9:13 — "Jacob have I loved, but Esau have I hated."

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| <p>3 <i>And I hated Esau, and laid his mountains and his heritage waste for the dragons of the wilderness.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Whereas Edom saith, We are impoverished, but we will return and build the desolate places; thus saith the LORD of hosts, They shall build, but I will throw down; and they shall call them, The border of wickedness, and, The people against whom the LORD hath indignation for ever.</i></p> | <p>and I hated Esau. I laid his mountains waste and gave his heritage over to the dragons of the wilderness."</p> <p>Edom says, "We are beaten down, but we will return and rebuild the desolate places." This is what the LORD of hosts says: "They may build, but I will throw it down. They shall be called the border of wickedness, and the people against whom the LORD has indignation forever."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Edom** (EE-dum) — The nation descended from Esau, settled south of the Dead Sea in the rugged region around Mount Seir. A standing enemy of Israel throughout the OT.

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| <p>5 <i>And your eyes shall see, and ye shall say, The LORD will be magnified from the border of Israel.</i></p> <p>6 <i>A son honoureth his father, and a servant his master: if then I be a father, where is mine honour? and if I be a master, where is my fear? saith the LORD of hosts unto you, O priests, that despise my name. And ye say, Wherein have we despised thy name?</i></p> <p>7 <i>Ye offer polluted bread upon mine altar; and ye say, Wherein have we polluted thee? In that ye say, The table of the LORD is contemptible.</i></p> | <p>Your own eyes shall see it, and You shall say, "The LORD is magnified beyond the border of Israel."</p> <p>"A son honors His father, and a servant His master. If then I am a Father, where is My honor? If I am a Master, where is My fear?" says the LORD of hosts to You, O priests who despise My name. Yet You say, "In what way have we despised Your name?"</p> <p>You offer polluted bread on My altar. And You say, "In what way have we polluted You?" By saying, "The table of the LORD is contemptible."</p> |
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- 8 *And if ye offer the blind for sacrifice, is it not evil? and if ye offer the lame and sick, is it not evil? offer it now unto thy governor; will he be pleased with thee, or accept thy person? saith the LORD of hosts.* When You offer the blind animal as a sacrifice, is that not evil? When You offer the lame and the sick, is that not evil? Offer it now to Your governor — will He be pleased with You, or accept You favorably?" says the LORD of hosts.
- 9 *And now, I pray you, beseech God that he will be gracious unto us: this hath been by your means: will he regard your persons? saith the LORD of hosts.* "And now, plead with God that He will be gracious to us. This has come from Your hand — will He regard You favorably?" says the LORD of hosts.
- 10 *Who is there even among you that would shut the doors for nought? neither do ye kindle fire on mine altar for nought. I have no pleasure in you, saith the LORD of hosts, neither will I accept an offering at your hand.* "Oh that one of You would shut the temple doors, so that You would not kindle a useless fire on My altar! I have no pleasure in You," says the LORD of hosts, "nor will I accept an offering from Your hand.
- 11 *For from the rising of the sun even unto the going down of the same my name shall be great among the Gentiles; and in every place incense shall be offered unto my name, and a pure offering: for my name shall be great among the heathen, saith the LORD of hosts.* For from the rising of the sun even unto the going down of the same, My name shall be great among the Gentiles. In every place incense shall be offered to My name, and a pure offering. For My name shall be great among the heathen," says the LORD of hosts.
- 12 *But ye have profaned it, in that ye say, The table of the LORD is polluted; and the fruit thereof, even his meat, is contemptible.* "But You have profaned it, in that You say, 'The table of the LORD is polluted, and its fruit, even its food, is contemptible.'

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| <p>13 <i>Ye said also, Behold, what a weariness is it! and ye have snuffed at it, saith the LORD of hosts; and ye brought that which was torn, and the lame, and the sick; thus ye brought an offering: should I accept this of your hand? saith the LORD.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But cursed be the deceiver, which hath in his flock a male, and voweth, and sacrificeth unto the Lord a corrupt thing: for I am a great King, saith the LORD of hosts, and my name is dreadful among the heathen.</i></p> | <p>You also say, 'What a weariness it is!' and You sneer at it," says the LORD of hosts. "You bring what was torn, and the lame, and the sick — and this is the offering You bring. Should I accept this from Your hand?" says the LORD.</p> <p>"Cursed is the deceiver who has a sound male in his flock, and vows to give it, yet sacrifices to the Lord what is corrupt. For I am a great King," says the LORD of hosts, "and My name is to be feared among the heathen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 31:3; Isa 41:8-9; Deut 10:15; Rom 9:10-13
v4 — Ezek 25:14; Ezek 35:9
v5 — Deut 11:7; Luke 10:23-24
v6 — Luke 6:46; Isa 1:2; John 13:13-17; Ex 20:12; 1 Pet 2:17-19
v7 — Mal 1:12; 1 Cor 11:27-32; 1 Cor 10:21; Mal 1:8
v8 — Deut 15:21; Lev 22:19-25; Hos 8:13; Jer 14:10
v9 — John 9:31; 1 Pet 1:17
v10 — 1 Pet 5:2
v11 — Isa 54:5; Isa 45:6; Matt 28:19; Zech 8:7; Isa 66:19-20
v14 — Acts 5:1-10; 2 Cor 8:12; Eccl 5:4-5; Luke 12:46; Ps 76:12

Chapter 2

The LORD rebukes the priests for failing to honor His name and corrupting the covenant of Levi. He condemns Judah for dealing treacherously — they have married the daughters of a foreign god and have broken faith with the wives of their youth. "The LORD, the God of Israel, says that He hates putting away" — yet they have wearied the LORD with their words, saying, "Where is the God of judgment?"

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| <p>1 <i>And now, O ye priests, this commandment is for you.</i></p> | <p>"And now, O priests, this commandment is for You.</p> |
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| <p>2 <i>If ye will not hear, and if ye will not lay it to heart, to give glory unto my name, saith the LORD of hosts, I will even send a curse upon you, and I will curse your blessings: yea, I have cursed them already, because ye do not lay it to heart.</i></p> <p>3 <i>Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread dung upon your faces, even the dung of your solemn feasts; and one shall take you away with it.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And ye shall know that I have sent this commandment unto you, that my covenant might be with Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>If You will not hear, and if You will not take it to heart to give glory to My name," says the LORD of hosts, "I will send a curse on You, and I will curse Your blessings. Indeed I have cursed them already, because You do not take it to heart.</p> <p>I will rebuke Your offspring, and spread dung on Your faces — the dung of Your solemn feasts — and You shall be carried away with it.</p> <p>Then You shall know that I have sent this commandment to You, so that My covenant with Levi may continue," says the LORD of hosts.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Levi** (LEE-vie) — Third son of Jacob; ancestor of the Levitical priesthood. "The covenant of Levi" is the perpetual covenant of priestly service first given in Numbers 18 and reaffirmed to Phinehas in Numbers 25:12–13. Malachi's complaint is that the present priests have corrupted that covenant.

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| <p>5 <i>My covenant was with him of life and peace; and I gave them to him for the fear wherewith he feared me, and was afraid before my name.</i></p> <p>6 <i>The law of truth was in his mouth, and iniquity was not found in his lips: he walked with me in peace and equity, and did turn many away from iniquity.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For the priest's lips should keep knowledge, and they should seek the law at his mouth: for he is the messenger of the LORD of hosts.</i></p> | <p>"My covenant with Him was of life and peace, and I gave them to Him so that He might fear Me — and He feared Me, and stood in awe of My name.</p> <p>The law of truth was in His mouth, and iniquity was not found on His lips. He walked with Me in peace and equity, and He turned many away from iniquity.</p> <p>The lips of a priest should keep knowledge, and people should seek the law from His mouth; for He is the messenger of the LORD of hosts.</p> |
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- 8 *But ye are departed out of the way; ye have caused many to stumble at the law; ye have corrupted the covenant of Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.* But You have departed from the way. You have caused many to stumble at the law. You have corrupted the covenant of Levi," says the LORD of hosts.
- 9 *Therefore have I also made you contemptible and base before all the people, according as ye have not kept my ways, but have been partial in the law.* "Therefore I have also made You contemptible and base before all the people, because you have not kept My ways but have been partial in the law."
- 10 *Have we not all one father? hath not one God created us? why do we deal treacherously every man against his brother, by profaning the covenant of our fathers?* Have we not all one Father? Has not one God created us? Why then do we deal treacherously each man against his brother, by profaning the covenant of our fathers?
- 11 *Judah hath dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Jerusalem; for Judah hath profaned the holiness of the LORD which he loved, and hath married the daughter of a strange god.* Judah has dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Jerusalem. For Judah has profaned the holiness of the LORD which He loved, and has married the daughter of a strange god.
- 12 *The LORD will cut off the man that doeth this, the master and the scholar, out of the tabernacles of Jacob, and him that offereth an offering unto the LORD of hosts.* The LORD will cut off the man who does this — the master and the scholar — from the tabernacles of Jacob, and the one who brings an offering to the LORD of hosts.
- 13 *And this have ye done again, covering the altar of the LORD with tears, with weeping, and with crying out, insomuch that he regardeth not the offering any more, or receiveth it with good will at your hand.* And this is another thing You do: You cover the altar of the LORD with tears, with weeping, and with crying out, so that He no longer regards the offering, nor receives it with good will from Your hand.

- 14 *Yet ye say, Wherefore? Because the LORD hath been witness between thee and the wife of thy youth, against whom thou hast dealt treacherously: yet is she thy companion, and the wife of thy covenant.* Yet You say, "For what reason?" Because the LORD has been the witness between You and the wife of Your youth, against whom You have dealt treacherously — though she is Your companion, and the wife of Your covenant.
- 15 *And did not he make one? Yet had he the residue of the spirit. And wherefore one? That he might seek a godly seed. Therefore take heed to your spirit, and let none deal treacherously against the wife of his youth.* Did He not make them one, though He had the remainder of the Spirit? And why one? That He might seek a godly seed. Therefore take heed to Your spirit, and let no one deal treacherously against the wife of his youth.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Putting away** (PUT-ing uh-WAY) — KJV term for divorce — literally, sending the wife away. The KJV preserves the active, deliberate force of the Hebrew: a man putting his wife away. The verse says the LORD hates this — not merely the broken result, but the deliberate act of casting off the wife of one's covenant.

- 16 *For the LORD, the God of Israel, saith that he hateth putting away: for one covereth violence with his garment, saith the LORD of hosts: therefore take heed to your spirit, that ye deal not treacherously.* "For the LORD, the God of Israel, says that He hates putting away — for it covers one's garment with violence," says the LORD of hosts. "Therefore take heed to Your spirit, that You do not deal treacherously."
- 17 *Ye have wearied the LORD with your words. Yet ye say, Wherein have we wearied him? When ye say, Every one that doeth evil is good in the sight of the LORD, and he delighteth in them; or, Where is the God of judgment?* You have wearied the LORD with Your words. Yet You say, "In what way have we wearied Him?" In that You say, "Everyone who does evil is good in the sight of the LORD, and He delights in them," or, "Where is the God of judgment?"

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v2 — Luke 17:18; Rev 14:7; Ps 81:11-12; Ps 69:22; Lev 26:14-46

v3 — Nah 3:6; Mal 2:9

v5 — Num 25:12-13; Ezek 37:26; Ezek 34:25; Num 16:9-10; Ex 32:26-29

v6 — Dan 12:3; 2 Tim 2:15-16; Rev 14:5; Jer 23:22; Acts 26:18

v7 — 2 Tim 2:24-25; Lev 10:11; Deut 21:5; 2 Cor 5:20; Acts 16:17

v9 — Deut 1:17; 1 Sam 2:30

v10 — Ps 100:3; Mal 2:11; 1 Cor 8:6; Eph 4:6; Isa 63:16

v11 — 2 Cor 6:14-18

v14 — Mal 2:15; Isa 54:6; Eccl 9:9; Gen 31:50; Prov 2:17

v15 — Matt 19:4-6; Mark 10:6-8; Mal 2:14; Gen 1:27; Gen 2:20-24

v16 — Matt 19:3-9; Matt 5:31-32; Mark 10:2-12; Luke 16:18; Prov 28:13

v17 — Isa 43:24; 2 Pet 3:3-4

Chapter 3

The LORD will send His messenger to prepare the way, and the Lord they seek will suddenly come to His temple. He will be like a refiner's fire and like fullers' soap, purifying the sons of Levi. The LORD rebukes Israel for robbing Him in tithes and offerings: "Bring all the tithes into the storehouse, and prove Me now — I will open the windows of heaven and pour out a blessing you cannot contain." A book of remembrance is written for those who fear the LORD.

- 1 *Behold, I will send my messenger, and he shall prepare the way before me: and the Lord, whom ye seek, shall suddenly come to his temple, even the messenger of the covenant, whom ye delight in: behold, he shall come, saith the LORD of hosts.* "I will send My messenger, and He shall prepare the way before Me. And the Lord whom You seek shall suddenly come to His temple — even the messenger of the covenant, in whom you delight. He shall come," says the LORD of hosts.
- 2 *But who may abide the day of his coming? and who shall stand when he appeareth? for he is like a refiner's fire, and like fullers' soap:* "But who can endure the day of His coming? Who can stand when He appears? For He is like a refiner's fire, and like fullers' soap.
- 3 *And he shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver: and he shall purify the sons of Levi, and purge them as gold and silver, that they may offer unto the LORD an offering in righteousness.* He shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver. He shall purify the sons of Levi, and refine them as gold and silver, that they may offer to the LORD an offering in righteousness.

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| <p>4 <i>Then shall the offering of Judah and Jerusalem be pleasant unto the LORD, as in the days of old, and as in former years.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And I will come near to you to judgment; and I will be a swift witness against the sorcerers, and against the adulterers, and against false swearers, and against those that oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the fatherless, and that turn aside the stranger from his right, and fear not me, saith the LORD of hosts.</i></p> <p>6 <i>For I am the LORD, I change not; therefore ye sons of Jacob are not consumed.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Even from the days of your fathers ye are gone away from mine ordinances, and have not kept them. Return unto me, and I will return unto you, saith the LORD of hosts. But ye said, Wherein shall we return?</i></p> | <p>Then the offering of Judah and Jerusalem shall be pleasant to the LORD, as in the days of old, and as in former years.</p> <p>"And I will come near to You for judgment. I will be a swift witness against the sorcerers, against the adulterers, against the false swearers, against those who oppress the hired worker in His wages, the widow, and the fatherless, and those who turn aside the stranger from His right and do not fear Me," says the LORD of hosts.</p> <p>"For I am the LORD, I change not. Therefore You sons of Jacob are not consumed.</p> <p>From the days of Your fathers You have gone away from My ordinances and have not kept them. Return to Me, and I will return to You," says the LORD of hosts. But You say, "In what way shall we return?"</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Tithe** (TYTHE) — *The tenth part — a tenth of one's grain, herd, flock, and increase, brought into the storehouse of the LORD for the support of the priests, the Levites, the widow, the fatherless, and the stranger. To withhold the tithe is to rob God of what is His.*

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| <p>8 <i>Will a man rob God? Yet ye have robbed me. But ye say, Wherein have we robbed thee? In tithes and offerings.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Ye are cursed with a curse: for ye have robbed me, even this whole nation.</i></p> | <p>Will a man rob God? Yet You have robbed Me. But You say, "In what way have we robbed You?" In tithes and offerings.</p> <p>You are cursed with a curse, for You have robbed Me — even this whole nation.</p> |
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- 10 *Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in mine house, and prove me now herewith, saith the LORD of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough to receive it.* Bring all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be food in My house. Prove Me now in this, says the LORD of hosts, and see if I will not open You the windows of heaven and pour You out a blessing so great there shall not be room enough to receive it.
- 11 *And I will rebuke the devourer for your sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground; neither shall your vine cast her fruit before the time in the field, saith the LORD of hosts.* "And I will rebuke the devourer for Your sakes, and He shall not destroy the fruits of Your ground. Nor shall Your vine cast her fruit before its time in the field," says the LORD of hosts.
- 12 *And all nations shall call you blessed: for ye shall be a delightsome land, saith the LORD of hosts.* "And all nations shall call You blessed, for You shall be a delightsome land," says the LORD of hosts.
- 13 *Your words have been stout against me, saith the LORD. Yet ye say, What have we spoken so much against thee?* "Your words have been harsh against Me," says the LORD. "Yet You say, 'What have we spoken against You?'"
- 14 *Ye have said, It is vain to serve God: and what profit is it that we have kept his ordinance, and that we have walked mournfully before the LORD of hosts?* You have said, 'It is vain to serve God. What profit is it that we have kept His ordinance, and that we have walked as mourners before the LORD of hosts?'
- 15 *And now we call the proud happy; yea, they that work wickedness are set up; yea, they that tempt God are even delivered.* And now we call the proud blessed. Those who work wickedness are built up; those who tempt God go free."
- 16 *Then they that feared the LORD spake often one to another: and the LORD hearkened, and heard it, and a book of remembrance was written before him for them that feared the LORD, and that thought upon his name.* Then those who feared the LORD spoke often one to another, and the LORD listened and heard them. A book of remembrance was written before Him for those who feared the LORD and who thought upon His name.

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| <p>17 <i>And they shall be mine, saith the LORD of hosts, in that day when I make up my jewels; and I will spare them, as a man spareth his own son that serveth him.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Then shall ye return, and discern between the righteous and the wicked, between him that serveth God and him that serveth him not.</i></p> | <p>"They shall be Mine," says the LORD of hosts, "on that day when I make up My jewels. And I will spare them as a man spares his own son who serves him.</p> <p>Then you shall return and discern between the righteous and the wicked — between him who serves God and Him who does not serve Him."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — Mal 4:5; Luke 1:76; Mark 1:2-3; Isa 63:9; Luke 7:26-28
v2 — Zech 13:9; Isa 4:4; 1 Cor 3:13-15; Rev 6:17; 1 Pet 2:7-8
v3 — Isa 1:25; Prov 17:3; Zech 13:9; Heb 12:10; Dan 12:10
v5 — Jas 5:8-9; Heb 13:4; Deut 5:11; Jas 5:4; Deut 27:19
v6 — Num 23:19; Heb 13:8; Jas 1:17; Lam 3:22-23; Jer 32:27
v7 — Zech 1:3; Rom 10:21; Jas 4:8; Deut 31:20; Rom 10:3
v8 — Prov 3:9-10; Matt 22:21; Mark 12:17; Ps 29:2; Mal 1:13
v9 — Deut 28:15-19; Hag 1:6-11; Hag 2:14-17; Mal 2:2; Josh 22:20
v10 — 2 Cor 9:6-8; Matt 6:33; Prov 3:9-10; Ps 37:3; Deut 28:12
v16 — Rev 20:12; Ps 56:8; Mal 4:2; Rev 15:4; Isa 26:3
v17 — Ex 19:5; Deut 7:6; 2 Cor 6:18; Isa 62:3-4; Rom 8:32
v18 — Matt 25:46; Gen 18:25; Ps 58:10-11; Josh 24:15; Mal 3:14-15

Chapter 4

The day is coming that will burn like an oven — the proud and the wicked will be stubble. But for those who fear the LORD's name, the Sun of righteousness will arise with healing in His wings. "Remember the law of Moses My servant." The LORD will send Elijah the prophet before the great and dreadful day of the LORD, and he will turn the hearts of the fathers to the children and the children to the fathers.

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| 1 <i>For, behold, the day cometh, that shall burn as an oven; and all the proud, yea, and all that do wickedly, shall be stubble: and the day that cometh shall burn them up, saith the LORD of hosts, that it shall leave them neither root nor branch.</i> | "For the day is coming that shall burn as an oven. All the proud, and all who do wickedly, shall be stubble. The day that comes shall burn them up," says the LORD of hosts, "and it shall leave them neither root nor branch. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sun of righteousness** (*SUN* of *RY*-chuhs-ness) — A Messianic title found only here in all of Scripture. As the rising sun drives away the night and brings life, light, and warmth to a frozen world, so the Messiah rises upon those who fear His name. The phrase "with healing in his wings" pictures the sun's rays as outstretched wings carrying healing to the earth.

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| 2 <i>But unto you that fear my name shall the Sun of righteousness arise with healing in his wings; and ye shall go forth, and grow up as calves of the stall.</i> | But to You who fear My name, the Sun of righteousness shall arise with healing in His wings. And You shall go forth and grow up as calves of the stall. |
| 3 <i>And ye shall tread down the wicked; for they shall be ashes under the soles of your feet in the day that I shall do this, saith the LORD of hosts.</i> | You shall tread down the wicked, for they shall be ashes under the soles of Your feet on the day that I do this," says the LORD of hosts. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Moses** (*MOH*-ziz) — The leader of the Exodus and lawgiver of Israel; mediator of the old covenant. His law is here invoked at the very close of the OT canon as the standard the people must remember.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Horeb** (*HOR*-eb) — Another name for Mount Sinai, the mountain where Moses received the law from the LORD.

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| 4 <i>Remember ye the law of Moses my servant, which I commanded unto him in Horeb for all Israel, with the statutes and judgments.</i> | "Remember the law of Moses My servant, which I commanded him in Horeb for all Israel, with the statutes and judgments. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elijah** (*ee-LY*-juh) — "my God is the LORD" — The ninth-century BC prophet who confronted Ahab and Jezebel, called down fire on Mount Carmel, and was taken up alive in a whirlwind (2 Kgs 2). Here promised to return before the great and dreadful day of the LORD. Our Lord Jesus identified John the Baptist as the Elijah promised here (Matt 11:14; 17:12–13).

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| 5 | <i>Behold, I will send you Elijah the prophet before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD:</i> | <i>I will send You Elijah the prophet before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD.</i> |
| 6 | <i>And he shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children, and the heart of the children to their fathers, lest I come and smite the earth with a curse.</i> | <i>And He shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children, and the heart of the children to their fathers — lest I come and strike the earth with a curse."</i> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Thess 1:8; 2 Pet 3:7; Mal 3:2; Isa 47:14; Isa 5:24
- v2 — Jer 33:6; Ps 84:11; Isa 30:26; Luke 1:78; John 8:12
- v3 — Job 40:12; Rom 16:20; Mic 7:10; Zech 10:5; Mic 5:8
- v4 — Deut 4:10
- v5 — Luke 1:17; Matt 17:10-13; Mark 9:11-13; Matt 11:13-14; Mal 3:1
- v6 — Luke 1:16-17; Isa 11:4; Heb 10:26-31; Matt 23:35-38; Dan 9:11

THE 400 SILENT YEARS

Malachi's voice falls silent around 430 BC. For the next four centuries no prophet speaks for God in Israel — no vision, no oracle, no word from heaven. The Persian empire that allowed the temple to be rebuilt gives way to the Greek empire when Alexander the Great sweeps east in 332 BC, and Greek replaces Aramaic as the language of trade and learning. The Maccabean revolt of 167 BC liberates Jerusalem from the desecrations of Antiochus IV Epiphanes — but Rome arrives in 63 BC and absorbs Judea into its growing empire. During this long silence, Jewish scholars in Alexandria translate the Hebrew Scriptures into Greek (the Septuagint), and a body of literature is written that the 1611 KJV included as the Apocrypha — Tobit, Judith, 1 and 2 Maccabees, Sirach, Wisdom, and others — though these books are not part of the Protestant canon. When God speaks again, He speaks from Galilee, in the cry of an infant, four hundred years after Malachi laid down his pen.

Matthew

THE ROMAN PERIOD

Author: *Matthew (also called Levi), one of the twelve apostles — a former tax collector who left everything to follow Jesus. Early church testimony from Papias (c. AD 125) onward consistently names him as the author.*

Date written: *c. AD 50–70, likely before the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70.*

Written to: *Primarily a Jewish audience — Matthew's Gospel is saturated with OT quotations and fulfillment formulas ("that it might be fulfilled") that would resonate most deeply with readers steeped in the Hebrew Scriptures.*

Setting: *The Roman province of Judea under occupation. Jesus of Nazareth, a carpenter from Galilee, launches a three-year public ministry, gathers twelve disciples, and fulfills dozens of OT prophecies before being crucified and rising from the dead.*

Where this sits historically: *Written under the early Roman Empire during the reigns of Claudius and Nero — likely before the Jewish War of AD 66–70 that ended with the destruction of Jerusalem and the Temple under Titus.*

Contemporaries: *Mark and the early Pauline epistles (Galatians, 1–2 Thessalonians, 1–2 Corinthians, Romans) were being written in the same window, while James the brother of the Lord still led the Jerusalem church.*

Big themes:

- *Jesus as the Jewish Messiah — Matthew opens with a genealogy tracing Jesus to Abraham and David; He is the long-promised King*
- *The kingdom of heaven — Matthew uses this phrase thirty-two times; the Sermon on the Mount (chs. 5–7) is the kingdom's constitution*
- *Fulfillment of Scripture — Matthew quotes the OT more than any other Gospel, showing repeatedly that Jesus's life, death, and resurrection happened "that it might be fulfilled"*
- *Discipleship — the Great Commission (28:18–20) bookends a Gospel that is centrally concerned with making and teaching disciples*
- *The five discourses — Matthew organizes Jesus's teaching into five great blocks (chs. 5–7, 10, 13, 18, 24–25), possibly echoing the five books of Moses*

Key passages: *Matt 1:21; 5:3–12; 16:16; 26:28; 28:18–20*

How it fits: *Matthew stands first in the NT canon as the bridge between the two Testaments — the OT's promises on one side, Christ's fulfillment on the other. It is the most quoted Gospel in the early church fathers. Mark, Luke, and John each present the same story from different angles; together the four Gospels give the complete portrait of Christ.*

Chapter 1

Matthew traces the genealogy of Jesus Christ from Abraham through David to Joseph. An angel appears to Joseph in a dream, telling him that Mary's child is conceived by the Holy Ghost and that He shall be called JESUS, for He will save His people from their sins.

- 1

The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham.

This is the book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jesus** (JEE-zus) — "the LORD saves" — The name given by the angel, meaning God rescues His people from their sins. He is also called Christ, meaning "Anointed One" or Messiah.

- 2

Abraham begat Isaac; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat Judas and his brethren;

Abraham begat Isaac, and Isaac begat Jacob, and Jacob begat Judas and his brothers.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Begat** (bih-GAT) — An old word meaning "fathered" or "became the father of." The KJV uses "begat" throughout the genealogies to show the direct line of descent. It is kept here because it is a distinctive term of KJV genealogies.

- 3

And Judas begat Phares and Zara of Thamar; and Phares begat Esrom; and Esrom begat Aram;

Judas begat Phares and Zara by Thamar; Phares begat Esrom; Esrom begat Aram.
- 4

And Aram begat Aminadab; and Aminadab begat Naasson; and Naasson begat Salmon;

Aram begat Aminadab; Aminadab begat Naasson; Naasson begat Salmon.
- 5

And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;

Salmon begat Booz by Rachab; Booz begat Obed by Ruth; Obed begat Jesse.
- 6

And Jesse begat David the king; and David the king begat Solomon of her that had been the wife of Urias;

Jesse begat David the king; David the king begat Solomon by her who had been the wife of Urias.
- 7

And Solomon begat Roboam; and Roboam begat Abia; and Abia begat Asa;

Solomon begat Roboam; Roboam begat Abia; Abia begat Asa.
- 8

And Asa begat Josaphat; and Josaphat begat Joram; and Joram begat Ozias;

Asa begat Josaphat; Josaphat begat Joram; Joram begat Ozias.

- 9 *And Ozias begat Joatham; and Joatham begat Achaz; and Achaz begat Ezekias;* Ozias begat Joatham; Joatham begat Achaz; Achaz begat Ezekias.
- 10 *And Ezekias begat Manasses; and Manasses begat Amon; and Amon begat Josias;* Ezekias begat Manasses; Manasses begat Amon; Amon begat Josias.
- 11 *And Josias begat Jechonias and his brethren, about the time they were carried away to Babylon:* Josias begat Jechonias and his brothers, around the time they were carried away to Babylon.
- 12 *And after they were brought to Babylon, Jechonias begat Salathiel; and Salathiel begat Zorobabel;* After they were brought to Babylon, Jechonias begat Salathiel; Salathiel begat Zorobabel.
- 13 *And Zorobabel begat Abiud; and Abiud begat Eliakim; and Eliakim begat Azor;* Zorobabel begat Abiud; Abiud begat Eliakim; Eliakim begat Azor.
- 14 *And Azor begat Sadoc; and Sadoc begat Achim; and Achim begat Eliud;* Azor begat Sadoc; Sadoc begat Achim; Achim begat Eliud.
- 15 *And Eliud begat Eleazar; and Eleazar begat Matthan; and Matthan begat Jacob;* Eliud begat Eleazar; Eleazar begat Matthan; Matthan begat Jacob.
- 16 *And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ.* Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, Who is called Christ.
- 17 *So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ are fourteen generations.* So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations. From David to the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations. From the carrying away into Babylon to Christ are fourteen generations.

- 18 *Now the birth of Jesus Christ was on this wise: When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child of the Holy Ghost.* This is how the birth of Jesus Christ came about. His mother Mary was pledged in marriage to Joseph. Before they came together, she was found to be with child by the Holy Ghost.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *The Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. The KJV consistently uses "Ghost" where other translations say "Spirit." Both words translate the same Greek word. "Holy Ghost" is kept here as the KJV-faithful term.*

- 19 *Then Joseph her husband, being a just man, and not willing to make her a publick example, was minded to put her away privily.* Joseph her husband was a righteous man. He did not want to disgrace her publicly, so he decided to divorce her quietly.
- 20 *But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.* While He was thinking about this, an angel of the Lord appeared to Him in a dream. The angel said, "Joseph, son of David, do not be afraid to take Mary as your wife. What is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.
- 21 *And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for he shall save his people from their sins.* She will give birth to a son, and you shall call His name JESUS, for He will save His people from their sins."
- 22 *Now all this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying,* All this took place to fulfill what the Lord had spoken through the prophet:
- 23 *Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.* "A virgin shall be with child and will give birth to a son. They shall call His name Emmanuel" — which means, God with us.
- 24 *Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto him his wife:* Joseph woke from sleep and did as the angel of the Lord had commanded him. He took Mary as his wife.

- 25 *And knew her not till she had brought forth her firstborn son: and he called his name JESUS.*
- He did not come together with her until she had given birth to her firstborn son.
He called His name JESUS.

Words in this chapter:

- Holy Ghost** — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'
- Isaac** (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.
- Jacob** (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'
- Joseph** (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'
- Ruth** (*ROOTH*) — A Moabite woman who left her homeland to stay with her mother-in-law Naomi — her loyalty and faith led to marriage with Boaz and a place in the lineage of Christ.
- Solomon** (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gen 22:18; Rom 1:3; Gal 3:16; Rev 22:16; Ps 132:11
- v2 — Acts 7:8
- v3 — Gen 38:24-27; Gen 46:12; Gen 38:29-30
- v5 — Ruth 1:16-17; Heb 11:31; Jas 2:25; Josh 6:22-25; Ruth 1:4
- v16 — Matt 27:17; John 4:25; Luke 3:23
- v18 — Gal 4:4-5; Luke 1:27-38; Heb 10:5; Job 14:4; Gen 3:15
- v19 — Deut 22:21-24; Deut 24:1-4; John 8:4-5; Mark 6:20
- v20 — Prov 3:5-6; Luke 1:19; Matt 1:18; Joel 2:28; Matt 2:19
- v21 — Acts 13:23; Acts 4:12; John 1:29; 1 John 3:5; Col 1:20-23
- v22 — Luke 24:44; 1 Kgs 8:15; Matt 2:23; Acts 3:18; 1 Kgs 8:24
- v23 — Isa 7:14; Isa 9:6-7; Ps 46:11; John 1:14; Isa 12:2
- v24 — Jas 2:21-26; John 15:14; John 2:5-8; Ex 40:27; Ex 40:32

Chapter 2

Wise men from the east follow a star to find the newborn King in Bethlehem and present Him with gold, frankincense, and myrrh. Herod, enraged at the report of a rival king, orders the slaughter of all male children in Bethlehem, but Joseph flees with Mary and the child to Egypt.

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| 1 <i>Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judaea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men from the east to Jerusalem,</i> | Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judaea in the days of King Herod. Wise men from the east came to Jerusalem |
| 2 <i>Saying, Where is he that is born King of the Jews? for we have seen his star in the east, and are come to worship him.</i> | and asked, "Where is He who has been born King of the Jews? We saw his star in the east and have come to worship Him." |
| 3 <i>When Herod the king had heard these things, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him.</i> | When King Herod heard this, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him. |
| 4 <i>And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ should be born.</i> | He gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people and asked them where Christ was to be born. |
| 5 <i>And they said unto him, In Bethlehem of Judaea: for thus it is written by the prophet,</i> | They told him, "In Bethlehem of Judaea, for so it is written by the prophet: |
| 6 <i>And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda, art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come a Governor, that shall rule my people Israel.</i> | 'And you, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah, are by no means least among the rulers of Judah. From you shall come a Governor who will shepherd My people Israel.'" |
| 7 <i>Then Herod, when he had privily called the wise men, enquired of them diligently what time the star appeared.</i> | Then Herod called the wise men secretly and questioned them carefully about the exact time the star had appeared. |
| 8 <i>And he sent them to Bethlehem, and said, Go and search diligently for the young child; and when ye have found him, bring me word again, that I may come and worship him also.</i> | He sent them to Bethlehem and said, "Go and search carefully for the young child. When you have found Him, bring word back to me, so that I may come and worship Him also." |

- 9 *When they had heard the king, they departed; and, lo, the star, which they saw in the east, went before them, till it came and stood over where the young child was.* After they had heard the king, they departed. The star they had seen in the east went before them until it came and stood over where the young child was.
- 10 *When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceeding great joy.* When they saw the star, they rejoiced with great joy.
- 11 *And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother, and fell down, and worshipped him: and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh.* They came into the house and saw the young child with Mary his mother. They fell down and worshipped him. Opening their treasures, they presented Him with gifts — gold, frankincense, and myrrh.
- 12 *And being warned of God in a dream that they should not return to Herod, they departed into their own country another way.* Being warned by God in a dream not to return to Herod, they went back to their own country by another route.
- 13 *And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him.* After they had departed, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream. The angel said, "Get up, take the young child and his mother, and flee to Egypt. Stay there until I tell you, for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him."
- 14 *When he arose, he took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt:* Joseph rose, took the young child and his mother by night, and departed to Egypt.
- 15 *And was there until the death of Herod: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying, Out of Egypt have I called my son.* He stayed there until the death of Herod. This was to fulfill what the Lord had spoken through the prophet: "Out of Egypt I have called My Son."

- 16 *Then Herod, when he saw that he was mocked of the wise men, was exceeding wroth, and sent forth, and slew all the children that were in Bethlehem, and in all the coasts thereof, from two years old and under, according to the time which he had diligently enquired of the wise men.* Then Herod, seeing that the wise men had tricked him, was greatly enraged. He sent and killed all the male children in Bethlehem and in all its surrounding region, from two years old and under, according to the time he had carefully determined from the wise men.
- 17 *Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying,* Then was fulfilled what was spoken by the prophet Jeremy:
- 18 *In Rama was there a voice heard, lamentation, and weeping, and great mourning, Rachel weeping for her children, and would not be comforted, because they are not.* "A voice was heard in Rama — lamentation and weeping and great mourning. Rachel weeping for her children, and she would not be comforted, because they are no more."
- 19 *But when Herod was dead, behold, an angel of the Lord appeareth in a dream to Joseph in Egypt,* After Herod died, an angel of the Lord appeared in a dream to Joseph in Egypt
- 20 *Saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and go into the land of Israel: for they are dead which sought the young child's life.* and said, "Get up, take the young child and His mother, and go to the land of Israel. Those who sought the young child's life are dead."
- 21 *And he arose, and took the young child and his mother, and came into the land of Israel.* Joseph rose, took the young child and his mother, and came into the land of Israel.
- 22 *But when he heard that Archelaus did reign in Judaea in the room of his father Herod, he was afraid to go thither: notwithstanding, being warned of God in a dream, he turned aside into the parts of Galilee:* When he heard that Archelaus was reigning in Judaea in place of his father Herod, he was afraid to go there. Being warned by God in a dream, He turned aside to the region of Galilee.

23	<i>And he came and dwelt in a city called Nazareth: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophets, He shall be called a Nazarene.</i>	He came and lived in a city called Nazareth. This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophets: "He shall be called a Nazarene."
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Words in this chapter:

- scribes** — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.
- Herod** (*HEHR-od*) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.
- Judah** (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'
- Rachel** (*RAY-chel*) — Jacob's beloved second wife, Laban's younger daughter — mother of Joseph and Benjamin; died giving birth to Benjamin; her name means 'ewe.'
- Bethlehem** (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.
- Galilee** (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.
- Nazareth** (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Mic 5:2; John 7:42; Luke 2:4-7; Luke 2:11; Ps 72:9-12
- v2** — Num 24:17; Jer 23:5; Rev 22:16; Zech 9:9; Isa 9:6-7
- v3** — Acts 17:6-7; John 11:47-48; Matt 23:37
- v6** — Ezek 34:23-25; Mic 5:2; John 7:42; Isa 9:6-7; Gen 49:10
- v9** — Matt 2:2; 2 Pet 1:19; Ps 25:12; Prov 8:17
- v10** — Ps 105:3; Luke 2:10; Luke 2:20; Rom 15:9-13; Ps 67:4
- v11** — Isa 60:6; Ps 72:10; Luke 2:16; Matt 2:2; Ps 95:6
- v12** — Matt 2:19; Matt 2:22; Matt 2:13; Matt 27:19; Gen 31:24
- v13** — Acts 12:11; Matt 2:12; Matt 1:20; Acts 10:7; Acts 5:19
- v15** — Hos 11:1; Ex 4:22; Num 24:8; Luke 24:44
- v18** — Jer 31:15; Jer 9:17-21; Jer 4:31; Gen 35:16-20
- v23** — Judg 13:5; John 1:45-46

Chapter 3

John the Baptist preaches repentance in the wilderness of Judaea, baptizing crowds in the Jordan. Jesus comes from Galilee to be baptized, and the heavens open as the Spirit descends

like a dove and the Father declares, 'This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.'

- 1

In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea,
- In those days John the Baptist came preaching in the wilderness of Judaea.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **John the Baptist** (JON the BAP-tist) — "the LORD is gracious" — The forerunner of Jesus Christ, sent to prepare the way of the Lord. He preached repentance and baptized in the Jordan River.

- 2

And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.
- He said, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand."*
- 3

For this is he that was spoken of by the prophet Esaias, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.
- This is the one spoken of by the prophet Esaias: "The voice of one crying in the wilderness, 'Prepare the way of the Lord, make His paths straight.'"*
- 4

And the same John had his raiment of camel's hair, and a leathern girdle about his loins; and his meat was locusts and wild honey.
- John's clothes were made of camel's hair, with a leather belt around his waist. His food was locusts and wild honey.*
- 5

Then went out to him Jerusalem, and all Judaea, and all the region round about Jordan,
- Then Jerusalem and all Judaea and all the region around Jordan went out to him.*
- 6

And were baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins.
- They were baptized by him in the Jordan River, confessing their sins.*
- 7

But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees come to his baptism, he said unto them, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?
- When he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming to his baptism, he said to them, "You brood of vipers! Who warned you to flee from the wrath to come?"*
- 8

Bring forth therefore fruits meet for repentance:
- Bring forth fruit in keeping with repentance.*

- 9 *And think not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, that God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.* Do not think to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' I tell you, God is able to raise up children for Abraham from these stones.
- 10 *And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: therefore every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.* Even now the axe is laid to the root of the trees. Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.
- 11 *I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance: but he that cometh after me is mightier than I, whose shoes I am not worthy to bear: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost, and with fire:* I baptize You with water for repentance. But He who comes after me is mightier than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will baptize You with the Holy Ghost and with fire.
- 12 *Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.* His winnowing fork is in His hand. He will thoroughly clean out His threshing floor, gathering His wheat into the barn. But the chaff He will burn up with unquenchable fire."
- 13 *Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to Jordan unto John, to be baptized of him.* Then Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan, to John, to be baptized by him.
- 14 *But John forbad him, saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me?* John tried to stop him, saying, "I need to be baptized by You — and do You come to me?"
- 15 *And Jesus answering said unto him, Suffer it to be so now: for thus it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness. Then he suffered him.* Jesus answered Him, "Allow it now, for it is right for us to fulfill all righteousness." Then John allowed it.

- 16 *And Jesus, when he was baptized, went up straightway out of the water: and, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him:* When Jesus was baptized, He went up immediately out of the water. The heavens were opened to Him. He saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove and coming to rest on Him.
- 17 *And lo a voice from heaven, saying, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.* A voice from heaven said, "This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased."

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Sadducees (*SAD-yoo-seez*) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 40:3-6; John 1:6-8; Luke 1:13-17; Luke 1:76; Luke 3:1-20
- v2 — Matt 4:17; Mark 1:15; Dan 2:44; Matt 10:7; Luke 24:47
- v3 — Isa 40:3; Mal 3:1; John 1:23; Mark 1:3; Luke 1:76
- v4 — 2 Kgs 1:8; Zech 13:4; Matt 11:8; Mark 1:6; Lev 11:22
- v8 — Luke 3:8; Acts 26:20; 2 Pet 1:4-8; Gal 5:22-23; Phil 1:11
- v9 — Luke 3:8; Rom 9:7-8; Gal 3:27-29; John 8:33; Acts 13:26
- v10 — John 15:6; Luke 3:9; Matt 7:19; John 15:2; Luke 13:6-9
- v11 — Isa 4:4; Luke 3:16; Acts 1:5; Zech 13:9; Acts 2:2-4
- v12 — Mal 4:1; Matt 13:30; Luke 3:17; Isa 41:16; Jer 51:2
- v15 — John 4:34; Isa 42:21; John 15:10; Luke 1:6; Phil 2:7-8
- v16 — Isa 11:2; Mark 1:10; Luke 3:21-22; Isa 42:1; John 1:31-34
- v17 — Isa 42:1; Matt 17:5; Ps 2:7; Luke 9:35; Matt 12:18

Chapter 4

The Spirit leads Jesus into the wilderness, where Satan tempts Him three times and Jesus answers each temptation with Scripture. Jesus begins His public ministry in Galilee, calls His first disciples — Simon, Andrew, James, and John — and heals the sick throughout the region.

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| <p>1 <i>Then was Jesus led up of the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil.</i></p> | <p>Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.</p> |
|--|---|

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Tempt** (TEMPT) — To test or try someone, often with the goal of causing them to sin. The KJV uses "tempt" where modern versions sometimes say "test." This distinctive word is kept because it carries both the sense of testing and the lure toward evil.

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| <p>2 <i>And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was afterward an hungred.</i></p> | <p>After fasting forty days and forty nights, He was hungry.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And when the tempter came to him, he said, If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread.</i></p> | <p>The tempter came to Him and said, "If You are the Son of God, command that these stones be made into bread."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.</i></p> | <p>Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God.'"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Then the devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple,</i></p> | <p>Then the devil took him into the holy city and set him on the highest point of the temple.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And saith unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.</i></p> | <p>He said to Him, "If You are the Son of God, throw Yourself down. For it is written: 'He shall give His angels charge over You, and in their hands they shall lift You up, so that You will not strike Your foot against a stone.'"</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Jesus said unto him, It is written again, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to Him, "It is also written: 'You shall not tempt the Lord Your God.'"</p> |

- 8 *Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them;* Again, the devil took him to a very high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory.
- 9 *And saith unto him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me.* He said to Him, "All these things I will give You, if You will fall down and worship me."
- 10 *Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.* Then Jesus said to Him, "Away from Me, Satan! For it is written: 'You shall worship the Lord Your God, and Him only shall You serve.'"
- 11 *Then the devil leaveth him, and, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.* Then the devil left him. Angels came and ministered to him.
- 12 *Now when Jesus had heard that John was cast into prison, he departed into Galilee;* When Jesus heard that John had been put in prison, he departed to Galilee.
- 13 *And leaving Nazareth, he came and dwelt in Capernaum, which is upon the sea coast, in the borders of Zabulon and Nephthalim:* Leaving Nazareth, He went and lived in Capernaum by the sea, in the region of Zabulon and Nephthalim.
- 14 *That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,* This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Esaias:
- 15 *The land of Zabulon, and the land of Nephthalim, by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles;* "The land of Zabulon and the land of Nephthalim, by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles —
- 16 *The people which sat in darkness saw great light; and to them which sat in the region and shadow of death light is sprung up.* the people who sat in darkness have seen a great light. On those living in the land of the shadow of death, a light has dawned."
- 17 *From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.* From that time Jesus began to preach, saying, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand."

- 18 *And Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.* As Jesus was walking along the Sea of Galilee, He saw two brothers — Simon who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother — casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen.
- 19 *And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.* He said to them, "Follow Me, and I will make You fishers of men."
- 20 *And they straightway left their nets, and followed him.* Immediately they left their nets and followed Him.
- 21 *And going on from thence, he saw other two brethren, James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, in a ship with Zebedee their father, mending their nets; and he called them.* Going on from there, He saw two other brothers — James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother — in a boat with their father Zebedee, mending their nets. He called them.
- 22 *And they immediately left the ship and their father, and followed him.* Immediately they left the boat and their father, and followed Him.
- 23 *And Jesus went about all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing all manner of sickness and all manner of disease among the people.* Jesus went throughout all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every kind of sickness and every kind of disease among the people.
- 24 *And his fame went throughout all Syria: and they brought unto him all sick people that were taken with divers diseases and torments, and those which were possessed with devils, and those which were lunatick, and those that had the palsy; and he healed them.* News about Him spread throughout all Syria. They brought to Him all who were sick — those suffering from various diseases and pains, those possessed by demons, those who had seizures, and those who were paralyzed — and He healed them.

- 25 *And there followed him great multitudes of people from Galilee, and from Decapolis, and from Jerusalem, and from Judaea, and from beyond Jordan.* Large crowds followed Him from Galilee, and from Decapolis, and from Jerusalem, and from Judaea, and from beyond Jordan.
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Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 2:18; Luke 4:1-13; Mark 1:12-15; Heb 4:15-16; Rom 8:14
- v2 — Deut 9:18; Ex 34:28; 1 Kgs 19:8; Luke 4:2; Deut 9:9
- v4 — Deut 8:3; Luke 4:4; John 6:63; John 6:31-59; Rom 15:4
- v6 — Ps 91:11-12; Heb 1:14; Ps 34:7; 2 Cor 11:14; Ps 34:20
- v7 — Deut 6:16; 1 Cor 10:9; Ps 78:18; Ps 78:41; Heb 3:9
- v8 — 1 John 2:15-16; Rev 11:15; Ps 49:16-17; Matt 16:26; Luke 4:5-7
- v10 — Deut 6:13-14; Deut 10:20; Josh 24:14; Luke 4:8; 1 Sam 7:3
- v11 — Matt 26:53; Luke 22:43; Heb 1:14; Luke 4:13; Rev 5:11-12
- v16 — Isa 9:2; Isa 42:6-7; Luke 1:78-79; Isa 60:1-3; Mic 7:8
- v17 — Matt 3:2; Mark 1:14-15; Acts 2:38; Luke 5:32; Luke 24:47
- v19 — Mark 1:17-18; John 12:26; Matt 16:24; Luke 9:59; John 1:43
- v23 — Matt 9:35; Mark 1:39; Luke 7:22; Acts 10:38; Matt 11:5

Chapter 5

Jesus delivers the Sermon on the Mount, beginning with the Beatitudes. He teaches about the law, anger, lust, oaths, loving one's enemies, and the calling of His followers to be salt and light in the world.

- 1 *And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him:* Seeing the crowds, He went up on a mountain. When He sat down, His disciples came to Him.
- 2 *And he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying,* He opened His mouth and taught them, saying:

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| 3 | <i>Blessed are the poor in spirit: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.</i> | "Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. |
| 4 | <i>Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.</i> | Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted. |
| 5 | <i>Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth.</i> | Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth. |
| 6 | <i>Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled.</i> | Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be filled. |
| 7 | <i>Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.</i> | Blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MER-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God's mercy means He withholds the wrath we have earned. It is not the same as grace — mercy holds back judgment, while grace gives a gift we do not deserve.

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| 8 | <i>Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.</i> | Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God. |
| 9 | <i>Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.</i> | Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called the children of God. |
| 10 | <i>Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.</i> | Blessed are those who are persecuted for righteousness' sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. |
| 11 | <i>Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake.</i> | Blessed are You when men insult You, persecute You, and falsely say all kinds of evil against You for My sake. |
| 12 | <i>Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.</i> | Rejoice and be greatly glad, for great is Your reward in heaven. In the same way they persecuted the prophets who were before You. |

- 13 *Ye are the salt of the earth: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men.* You are the salt of the earth. But if the salt loses its flavor, how can it be made salty again? It is no longer good for anything — it is thrown out and trampled underfoot by men.
- 14 *Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid.* You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden.
- 15 *Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house.* No one lights a lamp and puts it under a basket, but on a lampstand. It gives light to everyone in the house.
- 16 *Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.* Let Your light shine before men in this way, so that they may see Your good works and glorify Your Father who is in heaven.
- 17 *Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil.* Do not think that I came to abolish the Law or the Prophets. I did not come to abolish them, but to fulfill them.
- 18 *For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.* Truly I tell You, until heaven and earth pass away, not one jot or one tittle will pass from the Law until all is fulfilled.
- 19 *Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.* Whoever breaks one of the least of these commandments and teaches others to do so will be called least in the kingdom of heaven. But whoever does and teaches them will be called great in the kingdom of heaven.
- 20 *For I say unto you, That except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven.* I tell You that unless Your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, You will by no means enter the kingdom of heaven.

- 21 *Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not kill; and whosoever shall kill shall be in danger of the judgment:* You have heard that it was said to the people of old, 'You shall not murder,' and 'Whoever murders will be in danger of judgment.'
- 22 *But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment: and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.* But I tell You that whoever is angry with his brother without a cause will be in danger of judgment. Whoever says to his brother, 'Raca,' will be in danger of the council. Whoever says, 'You fool,' will be in danger of hell fire.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — *The place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one English word, "hell," for several different Hebrew and Greek words — Sheol, Hades, and Gehenna. All refer to the realm of judgment and are kept as "hell" throughout this translation.*

- 23 *Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee;* So if You bring Your gift to the altar and there remember that Your brother has something against You,
- 24 *Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift.* leave Your gift there before the altar. Go and be reconciled to Your brother first, and then come and offer Your gift.
- 25 *Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison.* Settle quickly with Your opponent while You are on the way to court with Him. Otherwise He may hand You over to the judge, and the judge to the officer, and You will be thrown into prison.
- 26 *Verily I say unto thee, Thou shalt by no means come out thence, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing.* Truly I tell You, You will not get out until You have paid the very last penny.
- 27 *Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not commit adultery:* You have heard that it was said, 'You shall not commit adultery.'

- 28 *But I say unto you, That whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart.* But I tell You that anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in His heart.
- 29 *And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.* If Your right eye causes You to sin, pluck it out and throw it away. It is better for You that one part of Your body perish than that Your whole body be thrown into hell.
- 30 *And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.* If Your right hand causes You to sin, cut it off and throw it away. It is better for You that one part of Your body perish than that Your whole body go into hell.
- 31 *It hath been said, Whosoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a writing of divorcement:* It has been said, 'Whoever divorces his wife, let him give her a certificate of divorce.'
- 32 *But I say unto you, That whosoever shall put away his wife, saving for the cause of fornication, causeth her to commit adultery: and whosoever shall marry her that is divorced committeth adultery.* But I tell You that whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, causes her to commit adultery. Whoever marries a divorced woman commits adultery.
- 33 *Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of old time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself, but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths:* Again, You have heard that it was said to the people of old, 'You shall not swear falsely, but shall keep the oaths You made to the Lord.'
- 34 *But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne:* But I tell You, do not swear at all — not by heaven, for it is God's throne;
- 35 *Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King.* not by the earth, for it is His footstool; not by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great King.

- 36 *Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black.* Do not swear by Your head, for You cannot make one hair white or black.
- 37 *But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.* Let Your word be 'Yes, yes' or 'No, no.' Whatever is more than this comes from evil.
- 38 *Ye have heard that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth:* You have heard that it was said, 'An eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth.'
- 39 *But I say unto you, That ye resist not evil: but whosoever shall smite thee on thy right cheek, turn to him the other also.* But I tell You, do not resist an evil person. If someone strikes you on your right cheek, turn the other to Him as well.
- 40 *And if any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloke also.* If someone wants to sue you and take your coat, let him have Your cloak as well.
- 41 *And whosoever shall compel thee to go a mile, go with him twain.* If someone forces you to go one mile, go with him two miles.
- 42 *Give to him that asketh thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn not thou away.* Give to the one who asks you. Do not turn away from the one who wants to borrow from you.
- 43 *Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy.* You have heard that it was said, 'Love Your neighbor and hate Your enemy.'
- 44 *But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;* But I tell You, love Your enemies. Bless those who curse You. Do good to those who hate You. Pray for those who mistreat You and persecute You.
- 45 *That ye may be the children of your Father which is in heaven: for he maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust.* This is how You show You are children of Your Father in heaven. He makes His sun rise on the evil and on the good. He sends rain on the just and on the unjust.

46	<i>For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans the same?</i>	If You love only those who love You, what reward do You have? Even the tax collectors do the same.
47	<i>And if ye salute your brethren only, what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so?</i>	If You greet only Your brothers, what more are You doing than others? Even the tax collectors do the same.
48	<i>Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect.</i>	Be perfect, therefore, as Your Father in heaven is perfect."

Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Isa 66:2; Prov 29:23; Ps 34:18; Prov 16:19; Luke 18:14
- v4 — Rev 21:4; 2 Cor 7:9-10; Isa 61:2-3; John 16:20-22; Ps 126:5-6
- v5 — Ps 37:11; Isa 29:19; Jas 3:13; Ps 149:4; Gal 5:23
- v6 — Ps 107:9; John 4:14; John 6:27; John 6:48-58; Isa 55:1-3
- v8 — Ps 24:4; Ps 51:10; Heb 10:22; Heb 12:14; Ezek 36:25-27
- v9 — Heb 12:14; Jas 3:16-18; Rom 12:18; Gal 5:22; Ps 120:6
- v10 — Jas 1:12; 1 Pet 3:13-14; 2 Cor 4:17; Jas 1:2-5; Matt 5:3
- v11 — 1 Pet 4:14; Luke 21:17; Mark 13:13; Matt 24:9; Luke 6:22
- v13 — Col 4:6; Luke 14:34-35; Mark 9:49-50; Heb 6:4-6; Lev 2:13
- v14 — Phil 2:15; John 8:12; Eph 5:8-14; 1 Thess 5:5; Prov 4:18
- v16 — 1 Pet 2:12; Titus 2:7; John 15:8; 1 John 1:5-7; Phil 2:15-16
- v44 — Rom 12:14; 1 Pet 3:9; Luke 6:27-28; Rom 12:20-21; Prov 25:21-22

Chapter 6

Jesus continues the Sermon on the Mount, teaching about giving, prayer, and fasting in secret rather than for public display. He teaches the Lord's Prayer and instructs His disciples not to store up treasures on earth but to seek first the kingdom of God.

1	<i>Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven.</i>	"Be careful not to do Your acts of charity before men in order to be seen by them. If You do, You will have no reward from Your Father in heaven.
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn or deserve. Grace is the opposite of wages — it is freely given out of God's love, not because of anything we have done.

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| <p>2 <i>Therefore when thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.</i></p> | <p>So when You give to the needy, do not sound a trumpet before Yourself, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, to receive honor from men. Truly I tell You, they have their reward in full.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth:</i></p> | <p>When You give to the needy, do not let Your left hand know what Your right hand is doing,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>That thine alms may be in secret: and thy Father which seeth in secret himself shall reward thee openly.</i></p> | <p>so that Your giving may be in secret. Your Father who sees in secret will reward You openly.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.</i></p> | <p>When You pray, do not be like the hypocrites. They love to pray standing in the synagogues and on the street corners, to be seen by men. Truly I tell You, they have their reward in full.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.</i></p> | <p>But when You pray, go into Your room and shut the door. Pray to Your Father who is in secret. Your Father who sees in secret will reward You openly.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do: for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.</i></p> | <p>When You pray, do not use empty repetition as the heathen do. They think they will be heard because of their many words.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Be not ye therefore like unto them: for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.</i></p> | <p>Do not be like them, for Your Father knows what You need before You ask Him.</p> |

- 9 *After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.* Pray in this way: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be Your name.
- 10 *Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.* Your kingdom come. Your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
- 11 *Give us this day our daily bread.* Give us this day our daily bread.
- 12 *And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.* Forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.
- 13 *And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.* Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For Yours is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.'
- 14 *For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you:* If You forgive men their trespasses, Your heavenly Father will also forgive You.
- 15 *But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.* But if You do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will Your Father forgive Your trespasses.
- 16 *Moreover when ye fast, be not, as the hypocrites, of a sad countenance: for they disfigure their faces, that they may appear unto men to fast. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.* When You fast, do not look gloomy like the hypocrites. They put on a sad countenance so that men can see they are fasting. Truly I tell You, they have their reward in full.
- 17 *But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy face;* When You fast, anoint Your head and wash Your face,
- 18 *That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall reward thee openly.* so that You do not appear to men to be fasting, but only to Your Father who is in secret. Your Father who sees in secret will reward You openly.
- 19 *Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal:* Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal.

- 20 *But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break through nor steal:* Store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust destroys, and where thieves do not break in and steal.
- 21 *For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.* Where Your treasure is, there Your heart will be also.
- 22 *The light of the body is the eye: if therefore thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of light.* The lamp of the body is the eye. If Your eye is sound, Your whole body will be full of light.
- 23 *But if thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness. If therefore the light that is in thee be darkness, how great is that darkness!* But if Your eye is evil, Your whole body will be full of darkness. If the light in You is darkness, how great is that darkness!
- 24 *No man can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon.* No one can serve two masters. He will either hate the one and love the other, or He will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon.
- 25 *Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?* Therefore I tell You, do not be anxious about Your life — what You will eat or what You will drink — or about Your body, what You will put on. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes?
- 26 *Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?* Look at the birds of the air. They do not sow or reap or gather into barns, yet Your heavenly Father feeds them. Are You not much more valuable than they?
- 27 *Which of you by taking thought can add one cubit unto his stature?* Which of You by worrying can add a single hour to His life?

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| <p>28 <i>And why take ye thought for raiment? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin:</i></p> <p>29 <i>And yet I say unto you, That even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.</i></p> <p>30 <i>Wherefore, if God so clothe the grass of the field, which to day is, and to morrow is cast into the oven, shall he not much more clothe you, O ye of little faith?</i></p> <p>31 <i>Therefore take no thought, saying, What shall we eat? or, What shall we drink? or, Wherewithal shall we be clothed?</i></p> <p>32 <i>(For after all these things do the Gentiles seek:) for your heavenly Father knoweth that ye have need of all these things.</i></p> <p>33 <i>But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.</i></p> <p>34 <i>Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof.</i></p> | <p>Why are You anxious about clothes? Consider the lilies of the field — how they grow. They do not toil or spin.</p> <p>Yet I tell you that even Solomon in all his glory was not dressed like one of these.</p> <p>If God so clothes the grass of the field — which is alive today and tomorrow is thrown into the oven — will He not much more clothe you, O you of little faith?</p> <p>Therefore do not be anxious, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?'</p> <p>For the Gentiles seek all these things. Your heavenly Father knows that you need all of them.</p> <p>But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added to you.</p> <p>Therefore do not be anxious about tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious about its own things. Sufficient for the day is its own trouble."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

mammon (MAM-un) — An Aramaic word for wealth or riches — Jesus used it as a personified rival to God, warning that no one can serve both God and Mammon.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 23:5; John 12:43; Heb 6:10; Matt 23:28-30; Luke 16:15
- v6 — 2 Kgs 4:33; Matt 14:23; Isa 65:24; Acts 9:40; Ps 34:15
- v9 — Rev 4:11; Luke 11:1-4; Rom 8:15; Isa 64:8; Ps 111:9
- v10 — Heb 10:36; Matt 26:42; Matt 12:50; John 4:34; 1 Thess 5:18
- v12 — Eph 4:32; Mark 11:25; Eph 1:7; Matt 18:21-35; Col 3:13
- v14 — Eph 4:32; Mark 11:25; Col 3:13; Matt 7:2; Jas 2:13
- v19 — Heb 13:5; 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 12:21; Prov 23:4-5; Prov 16:16
- v21 — Col 3:1-3; Luke 12:34; 2 Cor 4:18; Prov 4:23; Isa 33:6
- v24 — 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 16:13; Jas 4:4; 1 Tim 6:9-10; Josh 24:15
- v25 — Phil 4:6; 1 Pet 5:7; Rom 8:32; Ps 55:22; Luke 12:22-31
- v33 — Luke 12:31; Matt 5:6; John 6:27; Ps 34:9-10; Ps 84:11-12
- v34 — Matt 6:25; John 14:27; Heb 13:5-6; John 16:33; Luke 11:3

Chapter 7

Jesus concludes the Sermon on the Mount with teaching about judging others, asking and receiving from God, the narrow gate, and recognizing false prophets by their fruits. He closes with the parable of the wise man who built his house on a rock and the foolish man who built on sand.

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| 1 | <i>Judge not, that ye be not judged.</i> | "Do not judge, so that You will not be judged. |
| 2 | <i>For with what judgment ye judge, ye shall be judged: and with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you again.</i> | With the judgment You use, You will be judged. With the measure You use, it will be measured back to You. |
| 3 | <i>And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye?</i> | Why do You see the speck in Your brother's eye but do not notice the plank in Your own eye? |
| 4 | <i>Or how wilt thou say to thy brother, Let me pull out the mote out of thine eye; and, behold, a beam is in thine own eye?</i> | How can You say to Your brother, 'Let me take the speck out of Your eye,' when there is a plank in Your own eye? |

- 5 *Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye; and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.* You hypocrite! First take the plank out of Your own eye. Then You will see clearly to remove the speck from Your brother's eye.
- 6 *Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine, lest they trample them under their feet, and turn again and rend you.* Do not give what is holy to dogs. Do not throw Your pearls before swine, lest they trample them underfoot and turn and tear You to pieces.
- 7 *Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you:* Ask, and it will be given to You. Seek, and You will find. Knock, and it will be opened to You.
- 8 *For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.* Everyone who asks receives. Everyone who seeks finds. To everyone who knocks, the door will be opened.
- 9 *Or what man is there of you, whom if his son ask bread, will he give him a stone?* Which of You, if His son asks for bread, will give Him a stone?
- 10 *Or if he ask a fish, will he give him a serpent?* Or if He asks for a fish, will He give Him a snake?
- 11 *If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children, how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?* If You then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to Your children, how much more will Your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!
- 12 *Therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets.* So in everything, do to others what You would have them do to You. This is the Law and the Prophets.
- 13 *Enter ye in at the strait gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat:* Enter through the narrow gate. Wide is the gate and broad is the way that leads to destruction, and many go through it.

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| 14 <i>Because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it.</i> | Narrow is the gate and difficult is the way that leads to life, and few find it. |
| 15 <i>Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravening wolves.</i> | Watch out for false prophets. They come to You in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravenous wolves. |
| 16 <i>Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?</i> | You will know them by their fruits. Do people pick grapes from thornbushes, or figs from thistles? |
| 17 <i>Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit; but a corrupt tree bringeth forth evil fruit.</i> | Likewise, every good tree bears good fruit, and every bad tree bears evil fruit. |
| 18 <i>A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.</i> | A good tree cannot bear evil fruit, and a bad tree cannot bear good fruit. |
| 19 <i>Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.</i> | Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. |
| 20 <i>Wherefore by their fruits ye shall know them.</i> | So You will know them by their fruits. |
| 21 <i>Not every one that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven; but he that doeth the will of my Father which is in heaven.</i> | Not everyone who says to Me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the kingdom of heaven — but only the one who does the will of My Father in heaven. |
| 22 <i>Many will say to me in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils? and in thy name done many wonderful works?</i> | Many will say to Me on that day, 'Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in Your name, and cast out demons in Your name, and do many mighty works in Your name?' |
| 23 <i>And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work iniquity.</i> | Then I will declare to them, 'I never knew You. Depart from Me, You who practice iniquity.' |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — Deep, twisted wrongdoing. Stronger than the word "sin" — it points to the corruption beneath the sinful act itself. Where sin is a miss of the mark, iniquity is the inner crookedness that causes the missing.

- 24

Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock:

Everyone who hears these words of Mine and does them will be like a wise man who built His house on the rock.
- 25

And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell not: for it was founded upon a rock.

The rain came down, the floods rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house — but it did not fall, because it was built on the rock.
- 26

And every one that heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, which built his house upon the sand:

Everyone who hears these words of Mine and does not do them will be like a foolish man who built His house on the sand.
- 27

And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell: and great was the fall of it.

The rain came down, the floods rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house — and it fell. Great was its fall."
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And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended these sayings, the people were astonished at his doctrine:

When Jesus had finished these sayings, the crowds were amazed at His teaching,
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For he taught them as one having authority, and not as the scribes.

for He taught them as one who had authority, and not as their scribes.

Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 6:37; Rom 2:1-2; Jas 4:11-12; Luke 6:41; Rom 14:10-13
- v3 — John 8:7-9; Gal 6:1; Luke 6:41-42; 2 Sam 12:5-6; Luke 18:11
- v6 — Prov 9:7-8; Prov 23:9; Matt 10:14-15; Prov 26:11; Matt 15:26
- v7 — Matt 21:22; 1 John 3:22; John 15:7; Mark 11:24; Ps 145:18-19
- v11 — Luke 11:11-13; Jas 1:17; Rom 8:32; Ps 84:11; Isa 49:15
- v12 — Luke 6:31; Rom 13:8-10; Gal 5:13-14; Mark 12:29-34; Lev 19:18

- v13 — Luke 13:24-25; Prov 16:25; John 14:6; John 10:9; Isa 55:7
- v14 — Luke 13:23-30; Matt 22:14; Matt 16:24-25; Rom 12:2; Isa 35:8
- v15 — 1 John 4:1; Matt 24:11; 2 Pet 2:1-3; Mark 13:22-23; Acts 20:29-31
- v21 — Rom 2:13; Luke 6:46; Jas 1:22; Luke 11:28; Titus 1:16
- v23 — Matt 25:41; Ps 6:8; Luke 13:27; Luke 13:25; Matt 25:12
- v24 — Luke 6:47-49; John 13:17; Luke 11:28; 1 Cor 3:10-11; 1 John 2:3

Chapter 8

Jesus heals a leper, the centurion's servant, and Peter's mother-in-law, then casts out demons and heals many who are sick. He calms a violent storm on the sea and drives a legion of demons out of two men in the country of the Gergesenes.

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| 1 | <i>When he was come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him.</i> | When Jesus came down from the mountain, large crowds followed Him. |
| 2 | <i>And, behold, there came a leper and worshipped him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.</i> | A man with leprosy came and knelt before him, saying, "Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean." |
| 3 | <i>And Jesus put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.</i> | Jesus stretched out His hand and touched Him, saying, "I am willing. Be clean." Immediately His leprosy was cleansed. |
| 4 | <i>And Jesus saith unto him, See thou tell no man; but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.</i> | Jesus said to Him, "See that You tell no one. Go, show yourself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, as a testimony to them." |
| 5 | <i>And when Jesus was entered into Capernaum, there came unto him a centurion, beseeching him,</i> | When Jesus entered Capernaum, a centurion came to Him, pleading with Him, |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Capernaum** (kuh-PER-nay-um) — A city on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee that became the base of Jesus' ministry in Galilee.

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| 6 | <i>And saying, Lord, my servant lieth at home sick of the palsy, grievously tormented.</i> | and saying, "Lord, my servant is lying at home paralyzed and in terrible pain." |
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- 7 *And Jesus saith unto him, I will come and heal him.* Jesus said to Him, "I will come and heal Him."
- 8 *The centurion answered and said, Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my servant shall be healed.* The centurion answered, "Lord, I am not worthy for You to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.
- 9 *For I am a man under authority, having soldiers under me: and I say to this man, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.* For I am a man under authority, with soldiers under me. I say to one, 'Go,' and He goes; to another, 'Come,' and He comes; and to my servant, 'Do this,' and He does it."
- 10 *When Jesus heard it, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.* When Jesus heard this, He was amazed. He said to those who followed, "Truly I tell You, I have not found such great faith — not even in Israel.
- 11 *And I say unto you, That many shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven.* I tell you that many will come from the east and the west and will sit down with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven.
- 12 *But the children of the kingdom shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.* But the sons of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."
- 13 *And Jesus said unto the centurion, Go thy way; and as thou hast believed, so be it done unto thee. And his servant was healed in the selfsame hour.* Jesus said to the centurion, "Go. Let it be done for you as you have believed." And His servant was healed that very hour.
- 14 *And when Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his wife's mother laid, and sick of a fever.* When Jesus came into Peter's house, he saw Peter's mother-in-law lying in bed with a fever.

- 15 *And he touched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.* He touched her hand, and the fever left her. She got up and began to serve Him.
- 16 *When the even was come, they brought unto him many that were possessed with devils: and he cast out the spirits with his word, and healed all that were sick:* When evening came, they brought to Him many who were possessed with demons. He drove out the spirits with a word and healed all who were sick.
- 17 *That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying, Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses.* This was to fulfill what was spoken by Esaias the prophet: "He himself took our infirmities and carried our sicknesses."
- 18 *Now when Jesus saw great multitudes about him, he gave commandment to depart unto the other side.* When Jesus saw large crowds around Him, He gave orders to cross to the other side.
- 19 *And a certain scribe came, and said unto him, Master, I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.* A certain scribe came and said to Him, "Master, I will follow You wherever You go."
- 20 *And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head.* Jesus said to Him, "Foxes have holes and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head."
- 21 *And another of his disciples said unto him, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.* Another of His disciples said to Him, "Lord, let me first go and bury my father."
- 22 *But Jesus said unto him, Follow me; and let the dead bury their dead.* But Jesus said to Him, "Follow Me, and let the dead bury their own dead."
- 23 *And when he was entered into a ship, his disciples followed him.* When He got into the boat, His disciples followed Him.
- 24 *And, behold, there arose a great tempest in the sea, insomuch that the ship was covered with the waves: but he was asleep.* Suddenly a great storm arose on the sea, so that the boat was being swamped by the waves. But Jesus was asleep.

- 25 *And his disciples came to him, and awoke him, saying, Lord, save us: we perish.* His disciples came and woke Him, saying, "Lord, save us! We are perishing!"
- 26 *And he saith unto them, Why are ye fearful, O ye of little faith? Then he arose, and rebuked the winds and the sea; and there was a great calm.* He said to them, "Why are You afraid, O You of little faith?" Then He rose and rebuked the winds and the sea, and there was a great calm.
- 27 *But the men marvelled, saying, What manner of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey him!* The men were amazed, saying, "What kind of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey Him!"
- 28 *And when he was come to the other side into the country of the Gergesenes, there met him two possessed with devils, coming out of the tombs, exceeding fierce, so that no man might pass by that way.* When He arrived on the other side in the country of the Gergesenes, two men possessed with demons came out of the tombs to meet Him. They were so fierce that no one could pass that way.
- 29 *And, behold, they cried out, saying, What have we to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God? art thou come hither to torment us before the time?* They cried out, "What do You want with us, Jesus, Son of God? Have You come here to torment us before the appointed time?"
- 30 *And there was a good way off from them an herd of many swine feeding.* A large herd of pigs was feeding some distance away.
- 31 *So the devils besought him, saying, If thou cast us out, suffer us to go away into the herd of swine.* The demons begged Him, "If You cast us out, send us into the herd of pigs."
- 32 *And he said unto them, Go. And when they were come out, they went into the herd of swine: and, behold, the whole herd of swine ran violently down a steep place into the sea, and perished in the waters.* He said to them, "Go." They came out and went into the pigs. The whole herd rushed down the steep bank into the sea and drowned in the waters.

- 33

And they that kept them fled, and went their ways into the city, and told every thing, and what was befallen to the possessed of the devils.

Those tending the pigs ran off, went into the city, and reported everything — including what had happened to the demon-possessed men.
- 34

And, behold, the whole city came out to meet Jesus: and when they saw him, they besought him that he would depart out of their coasts.

The whole city came out to meet Jesus. When they saw Him, they begged Him to leave their region.

Words in this chapter:

centurion (*sen-TYUR-ee-un*) — A Roman army officer commanding approximately 100 soldiers — several centurions in the NT show unusual faith in Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Ps 33:9; Luke 5:13; Matt 11:4-5; 2 Kgs 5:14; Mark 1:41
- v4 — Lev 14:2-32; Luke 17:14; Luke 5:14; Mark 7:36; Lev 13:2-46
- v8 — Ps 107:20; Luke 7:6-7; Ps 33:9; Mark 1:25-27; Matt 8:3
- v10 — Luke 7:9; Matt 15:28; Mark 6:6; Luke 5:20; Luke 7:50
- v12 — Matt 25:30; Luke 13:28; Matt 21:43; Matt 13:42; Matt 24:51
- v13 — Matt 9:29-30; Mark 9:23; John 4:50; Matt 17:20; Matt 9:22
- v16 — Ex 15:26; Matt 14:14; Luke 4:40; Mark 1:32-34; Mark 5:8
- v17 — Isa 53:4; 1 Pet 2:24; Matt 1:22
- v22 — Luke 15:32; Col 2:13; Eph 5:14; Eph 2:5; Eph 2:1
- v26 — Isa 41:10-14; Ps 65:7; Ps 107:28-30; Ps 89:9; Luke 8:24-25
- v28 — Luke 8:26-39; Mark 5:1-20; Acts 10:38; Matt 4:24
- v29 — Mark 1:24; Luke 4:34; Jas 2:19; Mark 5:7; Luke 8:28

Chapter 9

Jesus heals a paralytic, forgives his sins, and calls Matthew the tax collector to follow Him. He raises a ruler's daughter from the dead, heals a woman with a twelve-year flow of blood, gives sight to two blind men, and casts out a demon from a mute man.

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And he entered into a ship, and passed over, and came into his own city.

Jesus got into the boat, crossed over, and came to His own city.

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| <p>2 <i>And, behold, they brought to him a man sick of the palsy, lying on a bed: and Jesus seeing their faith said unto the sick of the palsy; Son, be of good cheer; thy sins be forgiven thee.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And, behold, certain of the scribes said within themselves, This man blasphemeth.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And Jesus knowing their thoughts said, Wherefore think ye evil in your hearts?</i></p> <p>5 <i>For whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and walk?</i></p> <p>6 <i>But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (then saith he to the sick of the palsy,) Arise, take up thy bed, and go unto thine house.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And he arose, and departed to his house.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But when the multitudes saw it, they marvelled, and glorified God, which had given such power unto men.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And as Jesus passed forth from thence, he saw a man, named Matthew, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he saith unto him, Follow me. And he arose, and followed him.</i></p> | <p>Some men brought to Him a paralyzed man lying on a mat. When Jesus saw their faith, He said to the paralyzed man, "Take courage, son. Your sins are forgiven."</p> <p>Some of the scribes said to themselves, "This man is blaspheming."</p> <p>Jesus, knowing their thoughts, said, "Why do You think evil in Your hearts?"</p> <p>For which is easier — to say, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Rise and walk'?</p> <p>But so that You may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins" — He then said to the paralyzed man — "Rise, take up Your mat, and go to Your house."</p> <p>The man rose and went to his house.</p> <p>When the crowds saw it, they were filled with awe and glorified God, Who had given such authority to men.</p> <p>As Jesus passed on from there, He saw a man named Matthew sitting at the tax collector's booth. He said to Him, "Follow Me." Matthew rose and followed him.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Matthew** (MATH-yoo) — "gift of God" — A tax collector called by Jesus to be one of His twelve apostles. He is also the author of this Gospel.

- 10 *And it came to pass, as Jesus sat at meat in the house, behold, many publicans and sinners came and sat down with him and his disciples.* As Jesus reclined at table in the house, many tax collectors and sinners came and sat down with Him and His disciples.
- 11 *And when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto his disciples, Why eateth your Master with publicans and sinners?* When the Pharisees saw this, they said to His disciples, "Why does Your Master eat with tax collectors and sinners?"
- 12 *But when Jesus heard that, he said unto them, They that be whole need not a physician, but they that are sick.* When Jesus heard this, He said, "Those who are well have no need of a doctor, but those who are sick do.
- 13 *But go ye and learn what that meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice: for I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.* Go and learn what this means: 'I desire mercy and not sacrifice.' For I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance."
- 14 *Then came to him the disciples of John, saying, Why do we and the Pharisees fast oft, but thy disciples fast not?* Then the disciples of John came to him and asked, "Why do we and the Pharisees fast often, but Your disciples do not fast?"
- 15 *And Jesus said unto them, Can the children of the bridechamber mourn, as long as the bridegroom is with them? but the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken from them, and then shall they fast.* Jesus said to them, "Can the wedding guests mourn while the bridegroom is with them? The days will come when the bridegroom is taken from them, and then they will fast.
- 16 *No man putteth a piece of new cloth unto an old garment, for that which is put in to fill it up taketh from the garment, and the rent is made worse.* No one sews a patch of unshrunk cloth on an old garment. The patch pulls away from the garment and the tear becomes worse.
- 17 *Neither do men put new wine into old bottles: else the bottles break, and the wine runneth out, and the bottles perish: but they put new wine into new bottles, and both are preserved.* Nor do people put new wine into old wineskins. If they do, the skins burst, the wine spills out, and the skins are ruined. They put new wine into new wineskins, and both are preserved."

- 18 *While he spake these things unto them, behold, there came a certain ruler, and worshipped him, saying, My daughter is even now dead: but come and lay thy hand upon her, and she shall live.* While He was saying these things, a ruler came and knelt before Him, saying, "My daughter has just died. But come and lay Your hand on her, and she will live."
- 19 *And Jesus arose, and followed him, and so did his disciples.* Jesus rose and followed Him, and so did His disciples.
- 20 *And, behold, a woman, which was diseased with an issue of blood twelve years, came behind him, and touched the hem of his garment:* A woman who had suffered from a discharge of blood for twelve years came up behind Him and touched the edge of His garment.
- 21 *For she said within herself, If I may but touch his garment, I shall be whole.* She said to herself, "If I only touch His garment, I will be healed."
- 22 *But Jesus turned him about, and when he saw her, he said, Daughter, be of good comfort; thy faith hath made thee whole. And the woman was made whole from that hour.* Jesus turned and saw her. He said, "Take courage, daughter. Your faith has made You well." The woman was healed from that moment.
- 23 *And when Jesus came into the ruler's house, and saw the minstrels and the people making a noise,* When Jesus came to the ruler's house and saw the flute players and the noisy crowd,
- 24 *He said unto them, Give place: for the maid is not dead, but sleepeth. And they laughed him to scorn.* He said, "Go away, for the girl is not dead but sleeping." They laughed at Him.
- 25 *But when the people were put forth, he went in, and took her by the hand, and the maid arose.* When the crowd had been put outside, He went in and took her by the hand. The girl arose.
- 26 *And the fame hereof went abroad into all that land.* The report of this spread throughout all that land.

- 27 *And when Jesus departed thence, two blind men followed him, crying, and saying, Thou Son of David, have mercy on us.* As Jesus passed on from there, two blind men followed Him, crying out, "Have mercy on us, Son of David!"
- 28 *And when he was come into the house, the blind men came to him: and Jesus saith unto them, Believe ye that I am able to do this? They said unto him, Yea, Lord.* When He entered the house, the blind men came to Him. Jesus said to them, "Do You believe that I am able to do this?" They said to Him, "Yes, Lord."
- 29 *Then touched he their eyes, saying, According to your faith be it unto you.* Then He touched their eyes, saying, "Let it be done to You according to Your faith."
- 30 *And their eyes were opened; and Jesus straitly charged them, saying, See that no man know it.* Their eyes were opened. Jesus sternly warned them, "See that no one knows about this."
- 31 *But they, when they were departed, spread abroad his fame in all that country.* But they went out and spread the news about Him throughout all that region.
- 32 *As they went out, behold, they brought to him a dumb man possessed with a devil.* As they were going out, they brought to Him a mute man who was possessed with a demon.
- 33 *And when the devil was cast out, the dumb spake: and the multitudes marvelled, saying, It was never so seen in Israel.* When the demon was cast out, the mute man spoke. The crowds were amazed and said, "Nothing like this has ever been seen in Israel!"
- 34 *But the Pharisees said, He casteth out devils through the prince of the devils.* But the Pharisees said, "He casts out demons by the ruler of the demons."
- 35 *And Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every sickness and every disease among the people.* Jesus went throughout all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every disease and sickness among the people.

36	<i>But when he saw the multitudes, he was moved with compassion on them, because they fainted, and were scattered abroad, as sheep having no shepherd.</i>	When He saw the crowds, He was moved with compassion for them, because they were weary and scattered, like sheep without a shepherd.
37	<i>Then saith he unto his disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few;</i>	He said to His disciples, "The harvest is plentiful, but the workers are few.
38	<i>Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.</i>	Pray therefore to the Lord of the harvest to send out workers into his harvest."

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Mark 2:1-12; Luke 5:18-26; Jer 31:33-34; Matt 9:22; Ps 32:1-2
- v5 — John 5:8-14; Mark 2:9-12; Acts 3:16; Luke 5:23-25; Acts 14:8-11
- v9 — Luke 5:27-38; Mark 2:14-22; 1 Kgs 19:19-21; Luke 19:2-10; Mark 3:18
- v12 — Luke 5:31; Rev 3:17-18; Jer 33:6; Luke 9:11; Mark 2:17
- v13 — Mark 2:17; Luke 19:10; Hos 6:6; Luke 5:32; Matt 12:7
- v20 — Luke 8:43-56; Matt 14:36; Mark 6:56; Mark 5:25-43; Deut 22:12
- v27 — Matt 15:22; Matt 20:30-31; Mark 10:46-48; Matt 11:5; Luke 18:38-39
- v29 — Matt 15:28; Mark 10:52; Matt 9:22; Matt 8:13; Matt 20:34
- v35 — Matt 4:23-24; Acts 10:38; Luke 4:43-44; Mark 6:56; Matt 11:5
- v36 — Num 27:17; Mark 6:34; Jer 50:6; Matt 14:14; Ezek 34:3-6
- v37 — Luke 10:2; Mark 16:15; 1 Cor 3:9; John 4:35-36; Matt 28:19
- v38 — Luke 10:1-2; Jer 3:15; 2 Thess 3:1; Acts 13:2; John 20:21

Chapter 10

Jesus sends the twelve apostles out with authority to heal the sick, raise the dead, and cast out demons, instructing them to go only to the lost sheep of Israel. He warns them of persecution, teaches them not to fear those who can kill the body, and declares that whoever confesses Him before men, He will confess before the Father.

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| 1 | <i>And when he had called unto him his twelve disciples, he gave them power against unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal all manner of sickness and all manner of disease.</i> | Jesus called His twelve disciples to Him and gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal every disease and every sickness. |
| 2 | <i>Now the names of the twelve apostles are these; The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;</i> | These are the names of the twelve apostles: first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother; |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Peter** (PEE-ter) — "rock" — *The Greek form of the Aramaic name Cephas. Simon was given this name by Jesus, signifying his role as a leader among the apostles.*

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| 3 | <i>Philip, and Bartholomew; Thomas, and Matthew the publican; James the son of Alphaeus, and Lebbaeus, whose surname was Thaddaeus;</i> | Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James the son of Alphaeus, and Lebbaeus, whose surname was Thaddaeus; |
| 4 | <i>Simon the Canaanite, and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed him.</i> | Simon the Canaanite, and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed him. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Judas Iscariot** (JOO-dus iss-KAIR-ee-ut) — *The meaning of "Iscariot" is uncertain — likely "man of Kerioth," a town in Judea. He was the apostle who betrayed Jesus for thirty pieces of silver.*

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| 5 | <i>These twelve Jesus sent forth, and commanded them, saying, Go not into the way of the Gentiles, and into any city of the Samaritans enter ye not:</i> | Jesus sent out these twelve and commanded them, "Do not go in the way of the Gentiles, and do not enter any city of the Samaritans. |
| 6 | <i>But go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.</i> | Go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. |
| 7 | <i>And as ye go, preach, saying, The kingdom of heaven is at hand.</i> | As You go, preach, saying, 'The kingdom of heaven is near.' |
| 8 | <i>Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils: freely ye have received, freely give.</i> | Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out demons. Freely You have received — freely give. |

- 9 *Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses,* Take no gold or silver or copper money in Your belts,
- 10 *Nor scrip for your journey, neither two coats, neither shoes, nor yet staves: for the workman is worthy of his meat.* nor a bag for the journey, nor two tunics, nor sandals, nor a staff. The worker is worthy of His food.
- 11 *And into whatsoever city or town ye shall enter, enquire who in it is worthy; and there abide till ye go thence.* Whatever city or town You enter, find out who is worthy in it, and stay there until You leave.
- 12 *And when ye come into an house, salute it.* When You enter a house, greet it.
- 13 *And if the house be worthy, let your peace come upon it: but if it be not worthy, let your peace return to you.* If the house is worthy, let Your peace come on it. If it is not worthy, let Your peace return to You.
- 14 *And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear your words, when ye depart out of that house or city, shake off the dust of your feet.* If anyone will not receive you or listen to your words, when You leave that house or city, shake the dust off Your feet.
- 15 *Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city.* Truly I tell You, it will be more bearable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that city.
- 16 *Behold, I send you forth as sheep in the midst of wolves: be ye therefore wise as serpents, and harmless as doves.* I am sending You out as sheep in the midst of wolves. Therefore be wise as serpents and innocent as doves.
- 17 *But beware of men: for they will deliver you up to the councils, and they will scourge you in their synagogues;* Be on guard against men, for they will hand You over to councils and flog You in their synagogues.

- 18 *And ye shall be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony against them and the Gentiles.* You will be brought before governors and kings for My sake, as a testimony to them and to the Gentiles.
- 19 *But when they deliver you up, take no thought how or what ye shall speak: for it shall be given you in that same hour what ye shall speak.* When they hand You over, do not worry about how or what You will say. What You are to say will be given to You in that hour.
- 20 *For it is not ye that speak, but the Spirit of your Father which speaketh in you.* For it is not You who speaks, but the Spirit of Your Father speaking through You.
- 21 *And the brother shall deliver up the brother to death, and the father the child: and the children shall rise up against their parents, and cause them to be put to death.* Brother will hand over brother to death, and a father His child. Children will rise up against parents and have them put to death.
- 22 *And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that endureth to the end shall be saved.* You will be hated by all for My name's sake. But the one who endures to the end will be saved.
- 23 *But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.* When they persecute You in one city, flee to the next. Truly I tell You, You will not have gone through all the cities of Israel before the Son of Man comes.
- 24 *The disciple is not above his master, nor the servant above his lord.* A disciple is not above His teacher, nor a servant above His master.
- 25 *It is enough for the disciple that he be as his master, and the servant as his lord. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more shall they call them of his household?* It is enough for the disciple to be like his teacher and the servant like his master. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more will they call those of his household!

- 26 *Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.* So do not fear them. There is nothing covered that will not be revealed, and nothing hidden that will not be made known.
- 27 *What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.* What I tell you in the dark, speak in the light. What you hear whispered, proclaim from the housetops.
- 28 *And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.* Do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul. Rather, fear Him who is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.
- 29 *Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father.* Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them falls to the ground without your Father's knowledge.
- 30 *But the very hairs of your head are all numbered.* Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered.
- 31 *Fear ye not therefore, ye are of more value than many sparrows.* So do not be afraid. You are of more value than many sparrows.
- 32 *Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men, him will I confess also before my Father which is in heaven.* So everyone who acknowledges Me before men, I will also acknowledge before My Father who is in heaven.
- 33 *But whosoever shall deny me before men, him will I also deny before my Father which is in heaven.* But whoever denies Me before men, I will also deny before My Father who is in heaven.
- 34 *Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.* Do not think that I came to bring peace on earth. I did not come to bring peace but a sword.
- 35 *For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.* For I came to set a man against his father, and a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law.

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| 36 <i>And a man's foes shall be they of his own household.</i> | A man's enemies will be those of his own household. |
| 37 <i>He that loveth father or mother more than me is not worthy of me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me.</i> | Whoever loves father or mother more than Me is not worthy of Me. Whoever loves son or daughter more than Me is not worthy of Me. |
| 38 <i>And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me.</i> | Whoever does not take up his cross and follow Me is not worthy of Me. |
| 39 <i>He that findeth his life shall lose it: and he that loseth his life for my sake shall find it.</i> | Whoever finds his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life for My sake will find it. |
| 40 <i>He that receiveth you receiveth me, and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.</i> | Whoever receives you receives Me, and whoever receives Me receives him who sent Me. |
| 41 <i>He that receiveth a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet's reward; and he that receiveth a righteous man in the name of a righteous man shall receive a righteous man's reward.</i> | Whoever receives a prophet because he is a prophet will receive a prophet's reward. Whoever receives a righteous man because he is a righteous man will receive a righteous man's reward. |
| 42 <i>And whosoever shall give to drink unto one of these little ones a cup of cold water only in the name of a disciple, verily I say unto you, he shall in no wise lose his reward.</i> | Whoever gives one of these little ones even a cup of cold water in the name of a disciple — truly I tell you, he will certainly not lose his reward." |

Words in this chapter:

publican — A Jewish tax collector working for Rome — despised by fellow Jews as a traitor and swindler; also called 'tax collectors' in modern translations.

Samaritans (*sah-MEHR-ih-tanz*) — People of mixed descent who lived in Samaria after the Assyrian conquest — Jews despised them as half-breeds who had corrupted their religion; Jesus's parable of the Good Samaritan shocked His audience.

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 9:1-6; Mark 3:13-15; Mark 6:7-13; Luke 10:19; Mark 16:17-18
- v8 — Acts 3:6; Luke 10:9; Acts 4:30; Matt 10:1; Acts 20:33-35
- v16 — Phil 2:15; Luke 10:3; 1 Cor 14:20; Col 4:5; Eph 5:15-17
- v20 — Luke 21:15; Acts 6:10; 2 Sam 23:2; Luke 12:12; 2 Pet 1:21
- v22 — Matt 24:13; Jas 1:12; Rev 2:10; Mark 13:13; Matt 10:39
- v28 — Luke 12:4-5; Isa 8:12-13; Rev 2:10; Jas 4:12; Eccl 8:12-13
- v32 — Rev 3:5; Rom 10:9-10; Luke 12:8-9; 1 John 4:15; 2 Tim 1:8
- v33 — 2 Tim 2:12; Luke 9:26; Luke 12:9; 1 John 2:23; 2 Pet 2:1
- v34 — Luke 12:49-53; Acts 14:4; Acts 13:45-50; Acts 14:2; John 7:40-52
- v37 — Luke 14:26; Matt 22:37; Phil 3:7-9; 2 Cor 5:14-15; Deut 33:9
- v38 — Luke 14:27; Mark 8:34; Matt 16:24; Luke 9:23-24; John 19:17
- v39 — John 12:25; Mark 8:35-36; Luke 17:33; Matt 16:25-26; Luke 9:24

Chapter 11

John the Baptist, imprisoned, sends messengers to ask Jesus if He is the promised Messiah, and Jesus points to His miracles as evidence. Jesus rebukes the cities of Chorazin, Bethsaida, and Capernaum for their unbelief and invites the weary and heavy-laden to come to Him for rest.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, when Jesus had made an end of commanding his twelve disciples, he departed thence to teach and to preach in their cities.</i> | When Jesus had finished giving instructions to His twelve disciples, He went on from there to teach and preach in their cities. |
| 2 | <i>Now when John had heard in the prison the works of Christ, he sent two of his disciples,</i> | When John heard in prison about the works of Christ, He sent word through His disciples |
| 3 | <i>And said unto him, Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?</i> | and asked Him, "Are You the One who is to come, or should we look for another?" |
| 4 | <i>Jesus answered and said unto them, Go and shew John again those things which ye do hear and see:</i> | Jesus answered them, "Go and tell John what you hear and see: |

- 5 *The blind receive their sight, and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.* The blind receive sight, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.
- 6 *And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.* Blessed is the one who does not stumble on account of Me."
- 7 *And as they departed, Jesus began to say unto the multitudes concerning John, What went ye out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken with the wind?* As they went away, Jesus began to speak to the crowds about John: "What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind?
- 8 *But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? behold, they that wear soft clothing are in kings' houses.* What then did You go out to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? Those who wear fine clothes are in kings' houses.
- 9 *But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? yea, I say unto you, and more than a prophet.* What did You go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell You — and more than a prophet.
- 10 *For this is he, of whom it is written, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.* This is the one of whom it is written: 'I am sending My messenger before Your face, who will prepare Your way before You.'
- 11 *Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.* Truly I tell You, among those born of women no one has arisen greater than John the Baptist. Yet the least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than He.
- 12 *And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.* From the days of John the Baptist until now, the kingdom of heaven has been advancing forcefully, and forceful men lay hold of it.
- 13 *For all the prophets and the law prophesied until John.* For all the Prophets and the Law prophesied until John.

- 14 *And if ye will receive it, this is Elias, which was for to come.* And if You are willing to accept it, He is Elias who was to come.
- 15 *He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.* Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear.
- 16 *But whereunto shall I liken this generation? It is like unto children sitting in the markets, and calling unto their fellows,* To what shall I compare this generation? It is like children sitting in the marketplaces and calling out to others:
- 17 *And saying, We have piped unto you, and ye have not danced; we have mourned unto you, and ye have not lamented.* 'We played the flute for You and You did not dance. We sang a lament and You did not mourn.'
- 18 *For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, He hath a devil.* For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, 'He has a demon.'
- 19 *The Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say, Behold a man gluttonous, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners. But wisdom is justified of her children.* The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, 'Look at this man — a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!' Yet wisdom is proved right by her deeds."
- 20 *Then began he to upbraid the cities wherein most of his mighty works were done, because they repented not:* Then Jesus began to denounce the cities where most of His mighty works had been done, because they did not repent.
- 21 *Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida! for if the mighty works, which were done in you, had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.* "Woe to You, Chorazin! Woe to You, Bethsaida! For if the mighty works done in You had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.
- 22 *But I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the day of judgment, than for you.* But I tell You, it will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment than for You.

- 23 *And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted unto heaven, shalt be brought down to hell: for if the mighty works, which have been done in thee, had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day.* And You, Capernaum — will You be lifted up to heaven? No, You will go down to hell. For if the mighty works done in You had been done in Sodom, it would have remained to this day.
- 24 *But I say unto you, That it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom in the day of judgment, than for thee.* But I tell You, it will be more bearable for the land of Sodom on the day of judgment than for You."
- 25 *At that time Jesus answered and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.* At that time Jesus said, "I thank You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because You have hidden these things from the wise and learned and revealed them to little children.
- 26 *Even so, Father: for so it seemed good in thy sight.* Yes, Father, for this was Your gracious will.
- 27 *All things are delivered unto me of my Father: and no man knoweth the Son, but the Father; neither knoweth any man the Father, save the Son, and he to whomsoever the Son will reveal him.* All things have been handed over to Me by My Father. No one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son — and anyone to whom the Son chooses to reveal him.
- 28 *Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.* Come to Me, all You who are weary and burdened, and I will give You rest.
- 29 *Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls.* Take My yoke on You and learn from Me, for I am meek and lowly in heart. You will find rest for Your souls.
- 30 *For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.* For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Isa 35:4-6; Isa 61:1-3; Isa 42:6-7; Luke 4:18; Isa 29:18
- v6 — 1 Cor 2:14; Isa 8:14-15; Matt 26:31; John 6:66; Rom 9:32-33
- v10 — Mal 3:1; Isa 40:3; Mal 4:5; Mark 1:2; Luke 7:26-27
- v11 — Luke 7:28; Eph 3:8; Matt 3:11; John 1:15; Matt 5:19
- v12 — Luke 16:16; Luke 13:24; Eph 6:11-13; Phil 2:12; John 6:27
- v14 — Mal 4:5; Mark 9:11-13; Matt 17:10-13; Luke 1:17; John 1:21-23
- v15 — Luke 8:8; Matt 13:9; Mark 4:23; Matt 13:43; Luke 14:35
- v25 — Matt 21:16; Ps 8:2; Matt 16:17; Luke 10:21-24; 1 Cor 1:18-29
- v27 — John 14:6-9; Matt 28:18; Luke 10:22; 2 John 1:9; John 17:25-26
- v28 — Matt 11:29; John 7:37; John 6:37; Gal 5:1; Isa 55:1-3
- v29 — Jer 6:16; 1 John 2:6; Phil 2:7-8; John 13:15; Luke 6:46-48
- v30 — 1 John 5:3; John 16:33; Phil 4:13; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Gal 5:1

Chapter 12

The Pharisees accuse Jesus of breaking the Sabbath when His disciples pluck grain, and Jesus heals a man with a withered hand on the Sabbath. The Pharisees attribute His power to Beelzebub, and Jesus warns that blasphemy against the Holy Ghost will not be forgiven. He declares that His true family are those who do the will of His Father.

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| 1 | <i>At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat.</i> | At that time Jesus walked through the grainfields on the Sabbath. His disciples were hungry and began to pick heads of grain and eat them. |
| 2 | <i>But when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto him, Behold, thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.</i> | When the Pharisees saw it, they said to Him, "Look, Your disciples are doing what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath." |
| 3 | <i>But he said unto them, Have ye not read what David did, when he was an hungred, and they that were with him;</i> | He said to them, "Have you not read what David did when he was hungry, and those who were with him — |

- 4 *How he entered into the house of God, and did eat the shewbread, which was not lawful for him to eat, neither for them which were with him, but only for the priests?* how he entered the house of God and ate the showbread, which was not lawful for Him to eat, nor for those with Him, but only for the priests?
- 5 *Or have ye not read in the law, how that on the sabbath days the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are blameless?* Or have you not read in the Law that on the Sabbath the priests in the temple break the Sabbath and yet are guiltless?
- 6 *But I say unto you, That in this place is one greater than the temple.* I tell you, something greater than the temple is here.
- 7 *But if ye had known what this meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice, ye would not have condemned the guiltless.* If you had known what this means — 'I desire mercy and not sacrifice' — you would not have condemned the guiltless.
- 8 *For the Son of man is Lord even of the sabbath day.* For the Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath."
- 9 *And when he was departed thence, he went into their synagogue:* Departing from there, He went into their synagogue.
- 10 *And, behold, there was a man which had his hand withered. And they asked him, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath days? that they might accuse him.* A man was there with a withered hand. They asked Jesus, "Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath?" — so they could accuse Him.
- 11 *And he said unto them, What man shall there be among you, that shall have one sheep, and if it fall into a pit on the sabbath day, will he not lay hold on it, and lift it out?* He said to them, "Which of You, if He has one sheep and it falls into a pit on the Sabbath, will not take hold of it and lift it out?
- 12 *How much then is a man better than a sheep? Wherefore it is lawful to do well on the sabbath days.* How much more valuable is a man than a sheep! So it is lawful to do good on the Sabbath."

- 13 *Then saith he to the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it forth; and it was restored whole, like as the other.* Then He said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He stretched it out, and it was restored — as whole as the other.
- 14 *Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him.* The Pharisees went out and plotted against Him, how they might destroy Him.
- 15 *But when Jesus knew it, he withdrew himself from thence: and great multitudes followed him, and he healed them all;* Jesus, knowing this, withdrew from there. Large crowds followed Him, and He healed them all.
- 16 *And charged them that they should not make him known:* He warned them not to make Him known,
- 17 *That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,* so that what was spoken by Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled:
- 18 *Behold my servant, whom I have chosen; my beloved, in whom my soul is well pleased: I will put my spirit upon him, and he shall shew judgment to the Gentiles.* "My servant whom I have chosen, My beloved in whom My soul delights — I will put My Spirit on Him, and He will proclaim justice to the Gentiles.
- 19 *He shall not strive, nor cry; neither shall any man hear his voice in the streets.* He will not quarrel or cry out. No one will hear his voice in the streets.
- 20 *A bruised reed shall he not break, and smoking flax shall he not quench, till he send forth judgment unto victory.* A bruised reed He will not break, and a smoldering wick He will not snuff out, until He leads justice to victory.
- 21 *And in his name shall the Gentiles trust.* In His name the Gentiles will hope."
- 22 *Then was brought unto him one possessed with a devil, blind, and dumb: and he healed him, insomuch that the blind and dumb both spake and saw.* Then a demon-possessed man who was blind and mute was brought to Him. He healed him, so that the mute man both spoke and saw.

- 23 *And all the people were amazed, and said, Is not this the son of David?* All the people were amazed and said, "Can this be the Son of David?"
- 24 *But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, This fellow doth not cast out devils, but by Beelzebub the prince of the devils.* But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, "This man casts out demons only by Beelzebub, the ruler of the demons."
- 25 *And Jesus knew their thoughts, and said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and every city or house divided against itself shall not stand:* Jesus knew their thoughts and said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to ruin. Every city or house divided against itself will not stand.
- 26 *And if Satan cast out Satan, he is divided against himself; how shall then his kingdom stand?* If Satan casts out Satan, he is divided against himself. How then will his kingdom stand?
- 27 *And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your children cast them out? therefore they shall be your judges.* If I cast out demons by Beelzebub, by whom do your own sons cast them out? They will be your judges.
- 28 *But if I cast out devils by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God is come unto you.* But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God has come to You.
- 29 *Or else how can one enter into a strong man's house, and spoil his goods, except he first bind the strong man? and then he will spoil his house.* How can anyone enter a strong man's house and carry off his possessions unless He first ties up the strong man? Then He can rob His house.
- 30 *He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth not with me scattereth abroad.* Whoever is not with Me is against Me. Whoever does not gather with Me scatters.
- 31 *Wherefore I say unto you, All manner of sin and blasphemy shall be forgiven unto men: but the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven unto men.* Therefore I tell You, every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven men. But the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost will not be forgiven.

- 32 *And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, neither in the world to come.* Whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven. But whoever speaks against the Holy Ghost will not be forgiven — not in this age or in the age to come.
- 33 *Either make the tree good, and his fruit good; or else make the tree corrupt, and his fruit corrupt: for the tree is known by his fruit.* Either make the tree good and its fruit good, or make the tree bad and its fruit bad. The tree is known by its fruit.
- 34 *O generation of vipers, how can ye, being evil, speak good things? for out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh.* You brood of vipers! How can You speak good things when You are evil? For out of the overflow of the heart the mouth speaks.
- 35 *A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth evil things.* The good man brings good things out of His good treasure. The evil man brings evil things out of His evil treasure.
- 36 *But I say unto you, That every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment.* I tell You that on the day of judgment, men will give account for every careless word they speak.
- 37 *For by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.* By Your words You will be justified, and by Your words You will be condemned."
- 38 *Then certain of the scribes and of the Pharisees answered, saying, Master, we would see a sign from thee.* Then some of the scribes and Pharisees said to Him, "Master, we want to see a sign from You."
- 39 *But he answered and said unto them, An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given to it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas:* He answered them, "An evil and adulterous generation seeks for a sign. But no sign will be given to it except the sign of the prophet Jonas.

- 40 *For as Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale's belly; so shall the Son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.* For just as Jonas was in the belly of the great fish three days and three nights, so the Son of Man will be in the heart of the earth three days and three nights.
- 41 *The men of Nineveh shall rise in judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: because they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here.* The men of Nineveh will stand up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it. For they repented at the preaching of Jonas, and something greater than Jonas is here.
- 42 *The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for she came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here.* The queen of the south will rise up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it. For she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and something greater than Solomon is here.
- 43 *When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest, and findeth none.* When an unclean spirit comes out of a man, it passes through waterless places seeking rest, and finds none.
- 44 *Then he saith, I will return into my house from whence I came out; and when he is come, he findeth it empty, swept, and garnished.* Then it says, 'I will return to my house from where I came.' When it comes, it finds the house empty, swept, and put in order.
- 45 *Then goeth he, and taketh with himself seven other spirits more wicked than himself, and they enter in and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first. Even so shall it be also unto this wicked generation.* Then it goes and brings with it seven other spirits more evil than itself, and they enter and live there. The final state of that man is worse than the first. So it will be with this evil generation."
- 46 *While he yet talked to the people, behold, his mother and his brethren stood without, desiring to speak with him.* While He was still speaking to the crowds, His mother and brothers stood outside, wanting to speak with Him.

47	<i>Then one said unto him, Behold, thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to speak with thee.</i>	Someone told him, "Your mother and brothers are standing outside, wanting to speak with You."
48	<i>But he answered and said unto him that told him, Who is my mother? and who are my brethren?</i>	He replied to the one who told him, "Who is My mother, and who are My brothers?"
49	<i>And he stretched forth his hand toward his disciples, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!</i>	Stretching out His hand toward His disciples, He said, "Here are My mother and My brothers.
50	<i>For whosoever shall do the will of my Father which is in heaven, the same is my brother, and sister, and mother.</i>	Whoever does the will of My Father in heaven is My brother and sister and mother."

Words in this chapter:

- shewbread** (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'
- sabbath** (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.
- Nineveh** (*NIN-eh-veh*) — The capital of Assyria — the great city to which Jonah was sent; when he preached, the whole city repented; it was later destroyed as Nahum prophesied.

Cross-References:

- v3** — 1 Sam 21:3-6; Luke 6:3; Mark 2:25-26; Matt 21:16; Mark 12:10
- v7** — Hos 6:6; Matt 9:13; Mic 6:6-8; Isa 1:11-17; Prov 17:15
- v18** — Isa 42:1; Luke 4:18; John 3:34; Acts 10:38; Isa 61:1-3
- v20** — Isa 42:3-4; Ezek 34:16; Isa 61:1-3; Ps 147:3; Luke 4:18
- v29** — Isa 49:24; Mark 3:27; Luke 11:21-22; 1 John 4:4; Rev 20:7-9
- v30** — Mark 9:40; Luke 11:23; Luke 9:50; Josh 24:15; 1 John 2:19
- v31** — Luke 12:10; Mark 3:28-30; Heb 10:29; Heb 10:26; Matt 12:31-32
- v33** — Luke 6:43-44; Matt 7:16-20; Jas 4:8; John 15:4-7; Matt 3:8-10
- v34** — Luke 6:45; Matt 15:18; Eph 4:29; 1 Sam 24:13; Jas 3:5-8
- v36** — Eccl 12:14; Rom 2:16; Rev 20:12; Jude 1:14-15; Eph 6:4-6
- v40** — Jonah 1:17; Matt 27:63-64; Matt 16:21; John 2:19; Matt 17:23
- v50** — Luke 8:21; Mark 3:35; John 15:14; Luke 11:27-28; Matt 28:10

Chapter 13

Jesus teaches the crowds in parables, including the sower, the wheat and tares, the mustard seed, the leaven, the hidden treasure, the pearl of great price, and the dragnet. His own people in Nazareth reject Him, and He marvels at their unbelief.

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| 1 <i>The same day went Jesus out of the house, and sat by the sea side.</i> | That same day Jesus went out of the house and sat by the sea. |
| 2 <i>And great multitudes were gathered together unto him, so that he went into a ship, and sat; and the whole multitude stood on the shore.</i> | Large crowds gathered around Him, so He got into a boat and sat down. All the crowd stood on the shore. |
| 3 <i>And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;</i> | He spoke many things to them in parables, saying: "A sower went out to sow. |
| 4 <i>And when he sowed, some seeds fell by the way side, and the fowls came and devoured them up:</i> | As He sowed, some seeds fell along the path, and the birds came and ate them up. |
| 5 <i>Some fell upon stony places, where they had not much earth: and forthwith they sprung up, because they had no deepness of earth:</i> | Other seeds fell on rocky ground, where they did not have much soil. They sprang up quickly because the soil was shallow. |
| 6 <i>And when the sun was up, they were scorched; and because they had no root, they withered away.</i> | When the sun rose, they were scorched. Since they had no root, they withered away. |
| 7 <i>And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprung up, and choked them:</i> | Other seeds fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked them. |
| 8 <i>But other fell into good ground, and brought forth fruit, some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold.</i> | Still other seeds fell on good soil and produced a crop — a hundredfold, sixtyfold, or thirtyfold. |
| 9 <i>Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.</i> | Whoever has ears, let him hear." |
| 10 <i>And the disciples came, and said unto him, Why speakest thou unto them in parables?</i> | The disciples came and asked Him, "Why do You speak to them in parables?" |

- 11 *He answered and said unto them, Because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given.* He answered, "It has been given to You to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it has not been given.
- 12 *For whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath.* Whoever has, more will be given to him, and he will have great abundance. Whoever does not have, even what he has will be taken from Him.
- 13 *Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand.* This is why I speak to them in parables — because seeing, they do not see; and hearing, they do not hear or understand.
- 14 *And in them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, By hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and shall not perceive:* In them the prophecy of Esaias is fulfilled: 'You will keep on hearing but never understand, and You will keep on seeing but never perceive.
- 15 *For this people's heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes they have closed; lest at any time they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and should understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.* For this people's heart has grown dull. Their ears are hard of hearing, and they have closed their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes and hear with their ears, understand with their hearts and turn — and I would heal them.'
- 16 *But blessed are your eyes, for they see: and your ears, for they hear.* But blessed are Your eyes, because they see, and Your ears, because they hear.
- 17 *For verily I say unto you, That many prophets and righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.* Truly I tell You, many prophets and righteous people longed to see what You see but did not see it, and to hear what You hear but did not hear it.

- 18 *Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.* Hear then the parable of the sower.
- 19 *When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, then cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart. This is he which received seed by the way side.* When anyone hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what was sown in His heart. This is what was sown along the path.
- 20 *But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth it;* As for what was sown on rocky ground, this is the one who hears the word and immediately receives it with joy.
- 21 *Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended.* But He has no root in Himself. He lasts only a short time. When trouble or persecution comes because of the word, He quickly falls away.
- 22 *He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.* As for what was sown among thorns, this is the one who hears the word, but the worries of this world and the deceitfulness of riches choke the word, and it becomes unfruitful.
- 23 *But he that received seed into the good ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth it; which also beareth fruit, and bringeth forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.* As for what was sown on good ground, this is the one who hears the word and understands it. He produces fruit — some a hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty."
- 24 *Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is likened unto a man which sowed good seed in his field:* He put another parable before them, saying, "The kingdom of heaven is like a man who sowed good seed in his field.
- 25 *But while men slept, his enemy came and sowed tares among the wheat, and went his way.* While men were sleeping, His enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat, then went away.

- 26 *But when the blade was sprung up, and brought forth fruit, then appeared the tares also.* When the grain sprouted and formed heads, the weeds also appeared.
- 27 *So the servants of the householder came and said unto him, Sir, didst not thou sow good seed in thy field? from whence then hath it tares?* The servants of the master came and said to Him, 'Sir, did You not sow good seed in Your field? Where then did the weeds come from?'
- 28 *He said unto them, An enemy hath done this. The servants said unto him, Wilt thou then that we go and gather them up?* He said to them, 'An enemy did this.' The servants asked Him, 'Do You want us to go and pull them up?'
- 29 *But he said, Nay; lest while ye gather up the tares, ye root up also the wheat with them.* He said, 'No, lest when You gather the weeds You root up the wheat with them.
- 30 *Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind them in bundles to burn them: but gather the wheat into my barn.* Let both grow together until the harvest. At harvest time I will tell the reapers: Gather the weeds first and bind them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn."
- 31 *Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and sowed in his field:* He put another parable before them, saying, "The kingdom of heaven is like a grain of mustard seed that a man took and sowed in his field.
- 32 *Which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof.* It is the smallest of all seeds, but when it grows, it becomes the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and nest in its branches."
- 33 *Another parable spake he unto them; The kingdom of heaven is like unto leaven, which a woman took, and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.* He spoke another parable to them: "The kingdom of heaven is like leaven that a woman took and mixed into three measures of flour, until all of it was leavened."

- 34 *All these things spake Jesus unto the multitude in parables; and without a parable spake he not unto them:* Jesus spoke all these things to the crowds in parables. He did not say anything to them without using a parable.
- 35 *That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying, I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things which have been kept secret from the foundation of the world.* This was to fulfill what was spoken by the prophet: "I will open My mouth in parables. I will utter things hidden since the foundation of the world."
- 36 *Then Jesus sent the multitude away, and went into the house: and his disciples came unto him, saying, Declare unto us the parable of the tares of the field.* Then Jesus sent the crowds away and went into the house. His disciples came to Him and said, "Explain to us the parable of the weeds in the field."
- 37 *He answered and said unto them, He that soweth the good seed is the Son of man;* He answered, "The one who sows the good seed is the Son of Man.
- 38 *The field is the world; the good seed are the children of the kingdom; but the tares are the children of the wicked one;* The field is the world. The good seed are the sons of the kingdom. The weeds are the sons of the evil one.
- 39 *The enemy that sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the world; and the reapers are the angels.* The enemy who sowed them is the devil. The harvest is the end of the world. The reapers are the angels.
- 40 *As therefore the tares are gathered and burned in the fire; so shall it be in the end of this world.* As the weeds are gathered and burned in the fire, so it will be at the end of this world.
- 41 *The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity;* The Son of Man will send out His angels, and they will gather out of His kingdom everything that causes sin and all who practice iniquity.

- 42 *And shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.* They will throw them into the furnace of fire. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.
- 43 *Then shall the righteous shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.* Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Whoever has ears, let him hear.
- 44 *Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto treasure hid in a field; the which when a man hath found, he hideth, and for joy thereof goeth and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.* The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field. When a man found it, he hid it again. Then in his joy he went and sold everything He had and bought that field.
- 45 *Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a merchant man, seeking goodly pearls:* Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant seeking fine pearls.
- 46 *Who, when he had found one pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had, and bought it.* When He found one pearl of great value, He went and sold everything He had and bought it.
- 47 *Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a net, that was cast into the sea, and gathered of every kind:* Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net that was thrown into the sea and gathered fish of every kind.
- 48 *Which, when it was full, they drew to shore, and sat down, and gathered the good into vessels, but cast the bad away.* When it was full, men drew it to shore. They sat down and sorted the good fish into containers, but threw out the bad ones.
- 49 *So shall it be at the end of the world: the angels shall come forth, and sever the wicked from among the just,* So it will be at the end of the world. The angels will come and separate the wicked from the righteous
- 50 *And shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.* and throw them into the furnace of fire. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.
- 51 *Jesus saith unto them, Have ye understood all these things? They say unto him, Yea, Lord.* Jesus said to them, "Have You understood all these things?" They said to Him, "Yes, Lord."

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| <p>52 <i>Then said he unto them, Therefore every scribe which is instructed unto the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which bringeth forth out of his treasure things new and old.</i></p> <p>53 <i>And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these parables, he departed thence.</i></p> <p>54 <i>And when he was come into his own country, he taught them in their synagogue, insomuch that they were astonished, and said, Whence hath this man this wisdom, and these mighty works?</i></p> <p>55 <i>Is not this the carpenter's son? is not his mother called Mary? and his brethren, James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas?</i></p> <p>56 <i>And his sisters, are they not all with us? Whence then hath this man all these things?</i></p> <p>57 <i>And they were offended in him. But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, save in his own country, and in his own house.</i></p> <p>58 <i>And he did not many mighty works there because of their unbelief.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "Therefore every scribe trained for the kingdom of heaven is like a master of a house who brings out of His treasure things new and old."</p> <p>When Jesus had finished these parables, He departed from there.</p> <p>Coming to His hometown, He taught them in their synagogue, so that they were astonished. They said, "Where did this man get this wisdom and these mighty works?"</p> <p>Is not this the carpenter's son? Is not His mother called Mary? Are not his brothers James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas?</p> <p>Are not all His sisters here with us? Where then did this man get all these things?"</p> <p>They were offended by Him. But Jesus said to them, "A prophet is not without honor except in His own hometown and in His own house."</p> <p>He did not do many mighty works there because of their unbelief.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

Cross-References:

v11 — 1 Cor 2:9-10; 1 Cor 2:14; Matt 19:11; Jas 1:5; 1 John 2:27

v12 — Matt 25:29; Mark 4:24-25; Luke 8:18; Luke 19:24-26; John 15:2-5
v14 — Isa 6:9-10; Ezek 12:2; 2 Cor 3:14; Luke 8:10; Acts 28:25-27
v15 — Isa 6:10; Mark 4:12; Zech 7:11; John 8:43-44; 2 Tim 2:25-26
v16 — Luke 10:23-24; Eph 1:17-18; Matt 16:17; John 20:29; Acts 26:18
v22 — 1 Tim 6:17; Luke 8:14; 1 Tim 6:9-10; Mark 4:18-19; Luke 12:15
v23 — Phil 1:11; Matt 12:33; John 15:16; Gal 5:22-23; Ps 92:13-15
v25 — 1 Pet 5:8; 2 Pet 2:1; Acts 20:30-31; Matt 13:39; Heb 12:15
v30 — Matt 3:12; 1 Tim 5:24; 1 Cor 4:5; Mal 3:18-4:1; John 15:6
v35 — Ps 78:2; Eph 3:9; 1 Pet 1:20-21; Rom 16:25-26; 1 Cor 2:7
v43 — Dan 12:3; Luke 12:32; Matt 25:34; Matt 11:15; 1 Cor 15:41-54
v44 — Prov 2:2-5; Col 2:3; Phil 3:7-9; Matt 6:21; Luke 14:33

Chapter 14

Herod beheads John the Baptist in prison after being manipulated by Herodias and her daughter. Jesus feeds five thousand men with five loaves and two fish, then walks on the water to His disciples' boat, and Peter briefly walks on the water before sinking in fear.

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| 1 | <i>At that time Herod the tetrarch heard of the fame of Jesus,</i> | At that time Herod the tetrarch heard the reports about Jesus. |
| 2 | <i>And said unto his servants, This is John the Baptist; he is risen from the dead; and therefore mighty works do shew forth themselves in him.</i> | He said to His servants, "This is John the Baptist. He has risen from the dead, and that is why these miraculous powers are at work in Him." |
| 3 | <i>For Herod had laid hold on John, and bound him, and put him in prison for Herodias' sake, his brother Philip's wife.</i> | For Herod had arrested John and bound him and put him in prison, for the sake of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Herodias** (heh-ROH-dee-us) — *The wife of Herod Philip who left him to live with his brother Herod Antipas, the tetrarch. John the Baptist rebuked this unlawful marriage, which led to his imprisonment and death.*

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| 4 | <i>For John said unto him, It is not lawful for thee to have her.</i> | For John had told him, "It is not lawful for you to have her." |
| 5 | <i>And when he would have put him to death, he feared the multitude, because they counted him as a prophet.</i> | Herod wanted to put John to death, but he feared the people because they regarded John as a prophet. |

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| 6 | <i>But when Herod's birthday was kept, the daughter of Herodias danced before them, and pleased Herod.</i> | When Herod's birthday came, the daughter of Herodias danced before the guests and pleased Herod. |
| 7 | <i>Whereupon he promised with an oath to give her whatsoever she would ask.</i> | He therefore promised with an oath to give her whatever she asked. |
| 8 | <i>And she, being before instructed of her mother, said, Give me here John Baptist's head in a charger.</i> | Prompted by her mother, she said, "Give me here the head of John the Baptist on a platter." |
| 9 | <i>And the king was sorry: nevertheless for the oath's sake, and them which sat with him at meat, he commanded it to be given her.</i> | The king was grieved, but because of his oath and his guests, he commanded it to be given. |
| 10 | <i>And he sent, and beheaded John in the prison.</i> | He sent and had John beheaded in the prison. |
| 11 | <i>And his head was brought in a charger, and given to the damsel: and she brought it to her mother.</i> | His head was brought on a platter and given to the girl, and she brought it to her mother. |
| 12 | <i>And his disciples came, and took up the body, and buried it, and went and told Jesus.</i> | John's disciples came and took the body and buried it. Then they went and told Jesus. |
| 13 | <i>When Jesus heard of it, he departed thence by ship into a desert place apart: and when the people had heard thereof, they followed him on foot out of the cities.</i> | When Jesus heard this, He withdrew from there by boat to a remote place by Himself. But when the crowds heard it, they followed Him on foot from the cities. |
| 14 | <i>And Jesus went forth, and saw a great multitude, and was moved with compassion toward them, and he healed their sick.</i> | When Jesus came ashore, He saw a large crowd. He was moved with compassion for them and healed their sick. |

- 15 *And when it was evening, his disciples came to him, saying, This is a desert place, and the time is now past; send the multitude away, that they may go into the villages, and buy themselves victuals.* When evening came, His disciples came to Him and said, "This is a remote place and the hour is already late. Send the crowds away so they can go into the villages and buy themselves food."
- 16 *But Jesus said unto them, They need not depart; give ye them to eat.* Jesus said, "They do not need to go away. You give them something to eat."
- 17 *And they say unto him, We have here but five loaves, and two fishes.* They said to Him, "We have only five loaves here and two fish."
- 18 *He said, Bring them hither to me.* He said, "Bring them here to Me."
- 19 *And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the grass, and took the five loaves, and the two fishes, and looking up to heaven, he blessed, and brake, and gave the loaves to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.* He directed the crowds to sit down on the grass. Taking the five loaves and two fish, He looked up to heaven and gave thanks. He broke the loaves and gave them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the crowds.
- 20 *And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the fragments that remained twelve baskets full.* They all ate and were satisfied. They picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.
- 21 *And they that had eaten were about five thousand men, beside women and children.* The number of those who ate was about five thousand men, besides women and children.
- 22 *And straightway Jesus constrained his disciples to get into a ship, and to go before him unto the other side, while he sent the multitudes away.* Immediately Jesus made His disciples get into the boat and go ahead of Him to the other side, while He sent the crowds away.
- 23 *And when he had sent the multitudes away, he went up into a mountain apart to pray: and when the evening was come, he was there alone.* After He had sent the crowds away, He went up on a mountain by Himself to pray. When evening came, He was there alone.

- 24 *But the ship was now in the midst of the sea, tossed with waves: for the wind was contrary.* The boat was already far from shore, being tossed by the waves, for the wind was against them.
- 25 *And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.* In the fourth watch of the night — between three and six in the morning — Jesus came to them, walking on the sea.
- 26 *And when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, It is a spirit; and they cried out for fear.* When the disciples saw Him walking on the sea, they were terrified. "It is a ghost!" they said, and they cried out in fear.
- 27 *But straightway Jesus spake unto them, saying, Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.* But Jesus immediately spoke to them: "Take courage! It is I. Do not be afraid."
- 28 *And Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.* Peter answered him, "Lord, if it is you, command me to come to You on the water."
- 29 *And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.* He said, "Come." Peter got out of the boat and walked on the water toward Jesus.
- 30 *But when he saw the wind boisterous, he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.* But when He noticed the strong wind, He was afraid. Beginning to sink, He cried out, "Lord, save me!"
- 31 *And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?* Immediately Jesus stretched out His hand and caught Him. He said, "O You of little faith, why did You doubt?"
- 32 *And when they were come into the ship, the wind ceased.* When they got into the boat, the wind died down.
- 33 *Then they that were in the ship came and worshipped him, saying, Of a truth thou art the Son of God.* Those in the boat worshiped Him, saying, "Truly You are the Son of God."
- 34 *And when they were gone over, they came into the land of Gennesaret.* When they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennesaret.

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And when the men of that place had knowledge of him, they sent out into all that country round about, and brought unto him all that were diseased;

The men of that place recognized Him and sent word throughout all the surrounding region. They brought to Him all who were sick.
- 36

And besought him that they might only touch the hem of his garment: and as many as touched were made perfectly whole.

They begged Him to let them touch even the edge of His garment. All who touched it were completely healed.

Words in this chapter:

victuals (VIT-ulz) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Cross-References:

- v14 — Heb 4:15; Matt 9:36; Heb 2:17; Matt 15:32-39; John 11:33-35
- v19 — 1 Sam 9:13; Mark 8:6-7; 1 Tim 4:4-5; Luke 24:30; Acts 27:35
- v22 — Mark 6:45-51; John 6:15-21
- v23 — Luke 6:12; Mark 6:46; Matt 26:36; John 6:15-17; Matt 6:6
- v25 — Job 9:8; Mark 6:48; John 6:19; Matt 24:43; Ps 93:3-4
- v26 — Rev 1:17; Mark 6:49-50; Luke 1:11-12
- v27 — John 16:33; Isa 41:10; Rev 1:17-18; Acts 23:11; Isa 41:4
- v28 — Rom 12:3; John 6:68; Matt 26:33-35
- v29 — Phil 4:13; Mark 9:23; Acts 3:16; Luke 17:6; Mark 11:22-23
- v30 — Lam 3:54-57; 2 Tim 4:16-17; Mark 14:38; Matt 8:24-25; Luke 22:54-61
- v31 — Jas 1:6-8; Ps 138:7; Gen 22:14; Matt 8:26; Matt 17:20
- v33 — Ps 2:7; John 11:27; Rom 1:4; John 1:49; Mark 1:1

Chapter 15

Jesus rebukes the Pharisees for placing their traditions above the commandments of God and teaches that what defiles a man comes from the heart, not from unwashed hands. He heals the daughter of a Canaanite woman and feeds four thousand men with seven loaves and a few fish.

- 1

Then came to Jesus scribes and Pharisees, which were of Jerusalem, saying,

Then some scribes and Pharisees came from Jerusalem to Jesus and said,
- 2

Why do thy disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? for they wash not their hands when they eat bread.

"Why do Your disciples break the tradition of the elders? They don't wash their hands before they eat."

- 3 *But he answered and said unto them, Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?* He answered, "Why do You also break the commandment of God for the sake of Your tradition?"
- 4 *For God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.* God commanded, 'Honor Your father and Your mother,' and 'Whoever curses his father or mother must be put to death.'
- 5 *But ye say, Whosoever shall say to his father or his mother, It is a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me;* But You say that if anyone tells his father or mother, 'Whatever help you might have received from me is a gift devoted to God,'
- 6 *And honour not his father or his mother, he shall be free. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.* he need not honor His father or mother. You have nullified the word of God for the sake of Your tradition.
- 7 *Ye hypocrites, well did Esaias prophesy of you, saying,* You hypocrites! Isaiah prophesied well about you when he said,
- 8 *This people draweth nigh unto me with their mouth, and honoureth me with their lips; but their heart is far from me.* "This people honors Me with their lips, but their heart is far from Me.
- 9 *But in vain they do worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.* Their worship of Me is empty, for they teach human rules as though they were God's commands."
- 10 *And he called the multitude, and said unto them, Hear, and understand:* He called the crowd to Him and said, "Listen and understand.
- 11 *Not that which goeth into the mouth defileth a man; but that which cometh out of the mouth, this defileth a man.* It is not what goes into the mouth that makes a person unclean. It is what comes out of the mouth that makes a person unclean."

- 12 *Then came his disciples, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the Pharisees were offended, after they heard this saying?* Then His disciples came and said to Him, "Do You know that the Pharisees were offended when they heard this?"
- 13 *But he answered and said, Every plant, which my heavenly Father hath not planted, shall be rooted up.* He answered, "Every plant that My heavenly Father has not planted will be pulled up by the roots.
- 14 *Let them alone: they be blind leaders of the blind. And if the blind lead the blind, both shall fall into the ditch.* Leave them alone. They are blind guides leading the blind. If the blind lead the blind, both will fall into a pit."
- 15 *Then answered Peter and said unto him, Declare unto us this parable.* Peter said to him, "Explain this parable to us."
- 16 *And Jesus said, Are ye also yet without understanding?* Jesus said, "Are You still so slow to understand?"
- 17 *Do not ye yet understand, that whatsoever entereth in at the mouth goeth into the belly, and is cast out into the draught?* Don't You see that whatever enters the mouth goes into the stomach and then out of the body?
- 18 *But those things which proceed out of the mouth come forth from the heart; and they defile the man.* But what comes out of the mouth comes from the heart, and those things make a person unclean.
- 19 *For out of the heart proceed evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false witness, blasphemies:* From the heart come evil thoughts, murder, adultery, sexual immorality, theft, false testimony, and slander.
- 20 *These are the things which defile a man: but to eat with unwashen hands defileth not a man.* These are what make a person unclean. But eating with unwashed hands does not make a person unclean."
- 21 *Then Jesus went thence, and departed into the coasts of Tyre and Sidon.* Jesus left from there and went to the region of Tyre and Sidon.

- 22 *And, behold, a woman of Canaan came out of the same coasts, and cried unto him, saying, Have mercy on me, O Lord, thou Son of David; my daughter is grievously vexed with a devil.* A Canaanite woman from that region came to Him, crying out, "Lord, Son of David, have mercy on me! My daughter is badly tormented by a demon."
- 23 *But he answered her not a word. And his disciples came and besought him, saying, Send her away; for she crieth after us.* He did not answer her a word. His disciples came and urged Him, "Send her away, for she keeps crying out after us."
- 24 *But he answered and said, I am not sent but unto the lost sheep of the house of Israel.* He answered, "I was sent only to the lost sheep of the house of Israel."
- 25 *Then came she and worshipped him, saying, Lord, help me.* But she came and knelt before Him, saying, "Lord, help me!"
- 26 *But he answered and said, It is not meet to take the children's bread, and to cast it to dogs.* He replied, "It is not right to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs."
- 27 *And she said, Truth, Lord: yet the dogs eat of the crumbs which fall from their masters' table.* She said, "Yes, Lord, yet even the dogs eat the crumbs that fall from their masters' table."
- 28 *Then Jesus answered and said unto her, O woman, great is thy faith: be it unto thee even as thou wilt. And her daughter was made whole from that very hour.* Then Jesus answered her, "Woman, Your faith is great! Let it be done for You as You wish." And her daughter was healed from that very hour.
- 29 *And Jesus departed from thence, and came nigh unto the sea of Galilee; and went up into a mountain, and sat down there.* Jesus left that place and went along the Sea of Galilee. He went up on a hillside and sat down.

- 30 *And great multitudes came unto him, having with them those that were lame, blind, dumb, maimed, and many others, and cast them down at Jesus' feet; and he healed them:* Large crowds came to Him, bringing the lame, the blind, the mute, the crippled, and many others, and laid them at His feet. He healed them.
- 31 *Insomuch that the multitude wondered, when they saw the dumb to speak, the maimed to be whole, the lame to walk, and the blind to see: and they glorified the God of Israel.* The crowd was amazed when they saw the mute speaking, the crippled made well, the lame walking, and the blind seeing. They praised the God of Israel.
- 32 *Then Jesus called his disciples unto him, and said, I have compassion on the multitude, because they continue with me now three days, and have nothing to eat: and I will not send them away fasting, lest they faint in the way.* Jesus called His disciples to Him and said, "I feel compassion for this crowd. They have been with Me three days and have nothing to eat. I don't want to send them away hungry, or they may collapse on the way."
- 33 *And his disciples say unto him, Whence should we have so much bread in the wilderness, as to fill so great a multitude?* His disciples said to Him, "Where would we get enough bread in this remote place to feed such a large crowd?"
- 34 *And Jesus saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven, and a few little fishes.* Jesus asked them, "How many loaves do You have?" They said, "Seven, and a few small fish."
- 35 *And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground.* He told the crowd to sit down on the ground.
- 36 *And he took the seven loaves and the fishes, and gave thanks, and brake them, and gave to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.* Then He took the seven loaves and the fish, gave thanks, broke them, and gave them to the disciples. The disciples gave them to the crowd.
- 37 *And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets full.* They all ate and were satisfied. Afterward the disciples picked up seven basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.

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| 38 <i>And they that did eat were four thousand men, beside women and children.</i> | The number of those who ate was four thousand men, besides women and children. |
| 39 <i>And he sent away the multitude, and took ship, and came into the coasts of Magdala.</i> | After sending the crowd away, He got into the boat and went to the region of Magdala. |
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Words in this chapter:

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Ex 20:12; Ex 21:17; Lev 20:9; Deut 5:16; Deut 21:18-21
- v8 — Isa 29:13; Ezek 33:31; Acts 8:21; 1 Pet 3:10; Jer 12:2
- v9 — Isa 29:13; Mark 7:7; 1 Tim 1:4; Titus 1:14; Col 2:18-22
- v11 — Mark 7:15; Matt 15:18-20; Jas 3:5-8; 1 Tim 4:4-5; Matt 12:34-37
- v13 — John 15:2; Isa 60:21; John 15:6; Isa 61:3; Ps 92:13
- v14 — Luke 6:39; Isa 56:10; Matt 23:16-24; Mal 2:8; Isa 9:16
- v18 — Prov 15:28; Matt 12:34; Matt 15:11; Jas 3:6-10; Prov 10:32
- v19 — Mark 7:21-23; Gal 5:19-21; Jer 17:9; Titus 3:2-6; Jas 1:13-15
- v24 — Matt 10:5-6; Rom 15:8; Acts 13:46; Jer 50:6-7; Ezek 34:5-6
- v26 — Mark 7:27-28; Matt 7:6; Phil 3:2; Eph 2:12; Gal 2:15
- v27 — Eph 3:8; Luke 16:21; 1 Tim 1:13-15; Luke 15:18-19; Rom 10:12
- v28 — Mark 9:23-24; Matt 8:13; Ps 145:19; Mark 5:34; Matt 9:22

Chapter 16

The Pharisees and Sadducees demand a sign, and Jesus warns His disciples of their leaven. Peter confesses that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus reveals that He must go to Jerusalem, suffer, be killed, and rise again on the third day.

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| 1 <i>The Pharisees also with the Sadducees came, and tempting desired him that he would shew them a sign from heaven.</i> | The Pharisees and Sadducees came to Jesus and tested Him by asking Him to show them a sign from heaven. |
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- 2 *He answered and said unto them, When it is evening, ye say, It will be fair weather: for the sky is red.* He replied, "When evening comes, You say, 'It will be good weather, for the sky is red.'
- 3 *And in the morning, It will be foul weather to day: for the sky is red and lowring. O ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky; but can ye not discern the signs of the times?* And in the morning You say, 'It will be stormy today, for the sky is red and threatening.' You know how to read the sky, but You cannot read the signs of the times.
- 4 *A wicked and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given unto it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas. And he left them, and departed.* A wicked and unfaithful generation asks for a sign. No sign will be given to it except the sign of the prophet Jonah." He left them and went away.
- 5 *And when his disciples were come to the other side, they had forgotten to take bread.* When the disciples crossed to the other side of the lake, they had forgotten to bring bread.
- 6 *Then Jesus said unto them, Take heed and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.* Jesus said to them, "Watch out — be on guard against the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees."
- 7 *And they reasoned among themselves, saying, It is because we have taken no bread.* They discussed this among themselves, saying, "He said this because we didn't bring bread."
- 8 *Which when Jesus perceived, he said unto them, O ye of little faith, why reason ye among yourselves, because ye have brought no bread?* Knowing their discussion, Jesus said, "You of little faith, why are You talking among yourselves about having no bread?
- 9 *Do ye not yet understand, neither remember the five loaves of the five thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?* Don't You remember the five loaves for the five thousand, and how many baskets You gathered?
- 10 *Neither the seven loaves of the four thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?* Or the seven loaves for the four thousand, and how many baskets You gathered?

- 11 *How is it that ye do not understand that I spake it not to you concerning bread, that ye should beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees?* How do You not understand that I was not talking about bread? Guard yourselves against the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees."
- 12 *Then understood they how that he bade them not beware of the leaven of bread, but of the doctrine of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.* Then they understood that He was not telling them to guard against the leaven in bread, but against the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees.
- 13 *When Jesus came into the coasts of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, saying, Whom do men say that I the Son of man am?* When Jesus came to the region of Caesarea Philippi, He asked His disciples, "Who do people say that the Son of Man is?"
- 14 *And they said, Some say that thou art John the Baptist: some, Elias; and others, Jeremias, or one of the prophets.* They replied, "Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others say Jeremiah or one of the prophets."
- 15 *He saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am?* "But who do you say I am?" He asked.
- 16 *And Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God.* Simon Peter answered, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."
- 17 *And Jesus answered and said unto him, Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-jona: for flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father which is in heaven.* Jesus replied, "Blessed are You, Simon son of Jonah! Flesh and blood did not reveal this to you, but My Father in heaven.
- 18 *And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.* And I tell you, you are Peter, and on this rock I will build My church. The gates of hell will not overcome it.

- 19 *And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.* I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven. Whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven."
- 20 *Then charged he his disciples that they should tell no man that he was Jesus the Christ.* Then He instructed the disciples to tell no one that he was the Christ.
- 21 *From that time forth began Jesus to shew unto his disciples, how that he must go unto Jerusalem, and suffer many things of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised again the third day.* From that time on, Jesus began to show His disciples that He must go to Jerusalem. He would suffer many things at the hands of the elders, chief priests, and scribes. He would be killed, and on the third day be raised to life.
- 22 *Then Peter took him, and began to rebuke him, saying, Be it far from thee, Lord: this shall not be unto thee.* Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him. "Never, Lord!" he said. "This will never happen to You!"
- 23 *But he turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan: thou art an offence unto me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.* Jesus turned and said to Peter, "Get behind Me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to Me. You are not setting your mind on the things of God, but the things of men."
- 24 *Then said Jesus unto his disciples, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.* Then Jesus said to His disciples, "If anyone wants to follow Me, he must deny himself, take up His cross, and follow Me.
- 25 *For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: and whosoever will lose his life for my sake shall find it.* Whoever wants to save his life will lose it. But whoever loses his life for My sake will find it.
- 26 *For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?* What does it profit a man to gain the whole world yet lose his own soul? What can a man give in exchange for his soul?

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| <p>27 <i>For the Son of man shall come in the glory of his Father with his angels; and then he shall reward every man according to his works.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Verily I say unto you, There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.</i></p> | <p>The Son of Man will come in the glory of His Father with His angels, and then He will reward each person according to what He has done.</p> <p>Truly I tell You, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see the Son of Man coming in His kingdom."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Jeremiah (*jair-eh-MY-ah*) — The 'weeping prophet' who warned Judah before the Babylonian exile — suffered greatly for his message; his name means 'the LORD throws' or 'the LORD exalts.'

Cross-References:

v13 — Luke 9:18-20; Mark 8:27-29; Dan 7:13; Matt 9:6; John 5:27
v16 — John 11:27; Matt 14:33; 1 John 4:15; Matt 27:54; 1 Tim 4:10
v17 — John 6:45; Eph 1:17-18; Matt 11:25-27; 1 John 5:20; Gal 1:16
v18 — Eph 2:19-22; 1 Cor 3:9-11; Isa 28:16; Col 1:18; Ps 125:1-2
v19 — Matt 18:18; Isa 22:22; Rev 1:18; John 20:23; Rev 3:7
v21 — Luke 24:6-7; Matt 17:22-23; Matt 20:17-19; 1 Cor 15:3-4; Matt 17:12
v23 — Rom 8:5-8; Col 3:2; Phil 3:19; Mark 8:33; 1 Cor 2:14-15
v24 — Matt 10:38; Luke 14:27; 1 Pet 4:1-2; Luke 9:23-27; Mark 10:21
v25 — Matt 10:39; Rev 12:11; Mark 8:35; John 12:25; Luke 17:33
v26 — Mark 8:36-37; Job 27:8; Luke 9:25; Luke 12:20; Ps 49:7-8
v27 — Ps 62:12; 2 Cor 5:10; Rom 2:6; Rom 14:12; Rev 22:12-15
v28 — Luke 9:27; Mark 9:1; John 8:52; Matt 26:64; Matt 10:23

Chapter 17

Jesus is transfigured on a high mountain before Peter, James, and John, and His face shines like the sun as Moses and Elijah appear with Him. He heals a demon-possessed boy the disciples could not cure and tells Peter to pay the temple tax with a coin found in a fish's mouth.

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| 1 <i>And after six days Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart,</i> | Six days later, Jesus took Peter, James, and John his brother and led them up a high mountain by themselves. |
| 2 <i>And was transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light.</i> | There He was transfigured before them. His face shone like the sun, and His clothes became as white as the light. |
| 3 <i>And, behold, there appeared unto them Moses and Elias talking with him.</i> | Moses and Elijah appeared and were talking with him. |
| 4 <i>Then answered Peter, and said unto Jesus, Lord, it is good for us to be here: if thou wilt, let us make here three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias.</i> | Peter said to Jesus, "Lord, it is good for us to be here. If You wish, I will make three shelters — one for You, one for Moses, and one for Elijah." |
| 5 <i>While he yet spake, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them: and behold a voice out of the cloud, which said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye him.</i> | While He was still speaking, a bright cloud came over them, and a voice from the cloud said, "This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased. Listen to Him!" |
| 6 <i>And when the disciples heard it, they fell on their face, and were sore afraid.</i> | When the disciples heard this, they fell face down and were terrified. |
| 7 <i>And Jesus came and touched them, and said, Arise, and be not afraid.</i> | Jesus came and touched them. "Get up," He said. "Do not be afraid." |
| 8 <i>And when they had lifted up their eyes, they saw no man, save Jesus only.</i> | When they looked up, they saw no one except Jesus. |
| 9 <i>And as they came down from the mountain, Jesus charged them, saying, Tell the vision to no man, until the Son of man be risen again from the dead.</i> | As they came down the mountain, Jesus instructed them, "Tell no one what you have seen until the Son of Man is raised from the dead." |

- 10 *And his disciples asked him, saying, Why then say the scribes that Elias must first come?* His disciples asked Him, "Why then do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?"
- 11 *And Jesus answered and said unto them, Elias truly shall first come, and restore all things.* Jesus replied, "Elijah does come first, and will restore all things.
- 12 *But I say unto you, That Elias is come already, and they knew him not, but have done unto him whatsoever they listed. Likewise shall also the Son of man suffer of them.* But I tell You, Elijah has already come, and they did not recognize Him but did to Him whatever they pleased. So also the Son of Man is going to suffer at their hands."
- 13 *Then the disciples understood that he spake unto them of John the Baptist.* Then the disciples understood that He was talking to them about John the Baptist.
- 14 *And when they were come to the multitude, there came to him a certain man, kneeling down to him, and saying,* When they came to the crowd, a man came to Jesus, knelt before Him, and said,
- 15 *Lord, have mercy on my son: for he is lunatick, and sore vexed: for oftentimes he falleth into the fire, and oft into the water.* "Lord, have mercy on my son. He has seizures and suffers greatly. He often falls into the fire and often into the water.
- 16 *And I brought him to thy disciples, and they could not cure him.* I brought Him to Your disciples, but they could not heal Him."
- 17 *Then Jesus answered and said, O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him hither to me.* Jesus answered, "You faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with You? How long shall I put up with You? Bring Him here to Me."
- 18 *And Jesus rebuked the devil; and he departed out of him: and the child was cured from that very hour.* Jesus rebuked the demon, and it came out of Him. The boy was healed from that very hour.

- 19 *Then came the disciples to Jesus apart, and said, Why could not we cast him out?* Afterward the disciples came to Jesus privately and asked, "Why couldn't we drive it out?"
- 20 *And Jesus said unto them, Because of your unbelief: for verily I say unto you, If ye have faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye shall say unto this mountain, Remove hence to yonder place; and it shall remove; and nothing shall be impossible unto you.* He said to them, "Because of Your unbelief. Truly I tell You, if You have faith as small as a mustard seed, You can say to this mountain, 'Move from here to there,' and it will move. Nothing will be impossible for You."
- 21 *Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.* But this kind does not go out except by prayer and fasting.
- 22 *And while they abode in Galilee, Jesus said unto them, The Son of man shall be betrayed into the hands of men:* While they were gathered in Galilee, Jesus said to them, "The Son of Man is going to be betrayed into the hands of men.
- 23 *And they shall kill him, and the third day he shall be raised again. And they were exceeding sorry.* They will kill Him, and on the third day He will be raised to life." The disciples were deeply grieved.
- 24 *And when they were come to Capernaum, they that received tribute money came to Peter, and said, Doth not your master pay tribute?* When they arrived in Capernaum, the collectors of the temple tax came to Peter and asked, "Doesn't your teacher pay the temple tax?"
- 25 *He saith, Yes. And when he was come into the house, Jesus prevented him, saying, What thinkest thou, Simon? of whom do the kings of the earth take custom or tribute? of their own children, or of strangers?* "Yes, He does," Peter replied. When Peter came into the house, Jesus spoke to Him first: "What do You think, Simon? From whom do earthly kings collect taxes — from their own sons or from others?"
- 26 *Peter saith unto him, Of strangers. Jesus saith unto him, Then are the children free.* "From others," Peter answered. "Then the sons are exempt," Jesus said to Him.

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| 27 <i>Notwithstanding, lest we should offend them, go thou to the sea, and cast an hook, and take up the fish that first cometh up; and when thou hast opened his mouth, thou shalt find a piece of money: that take, and give unto them for me and thee.</i> | But so that we may not offend them, go to the sea and cast a hook. Take the first fish that comes up, and when You open its mouth, You will find a coin. Take it and give it to them for My tax and Yours." |
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Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 9:28-36; Matt 26:37; Mark 5:37
- v2 — Ps 104:2; Matt 28:3; Luke 9:29; John 1:14; Rev 10:1
- v4 — Mark 9:5-6; Luke 9:33
- v5 — Matt 3:17; Matt 12:18; Deut 18:15; Mark 9:7; Rev 1:7
- v11 — Acts 3:21; Luke 1:16-17
- v14 — Mark 9:14-29; Mark 1:40
- v17 — Num 14:11; Matt 6:30; Mark 9:19; Heb 3:16-19; Mark 16:14
- v20 — Luke 17:6; Mark 11:23; Luke 1:37; Luke 18:27; Matt 21:21
- v22 — Matt 16:21; Luke 18:31-34; Mark 8:31; Matt 17:23; Luke 9:44-45
- v24 — Ex 38:26; Ex 30:13
- v25 — Matt 22:21; Matt 22:17; Rom 13:6-7; Matt 22:19
- v27 — 2 Cor 6:3; 1 Cor 8:9; 1 Cor 9:19-22; 2 Cor 8:9; 1 Cor 8:13

Chapter 18

Jesus teaches about humility, warning His disciples that they must become like little children to enter the kingdom of heaven. He tells the parable of the lost sheep and the parable of the unforgiving servant, and instructs on how to handle sin within the church.

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| 1 <i>At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?</i> | At that time the disciples came to Jesus and asked, "Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?" |
| 2 <i>And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them,</i> | He called a little child over and set Him in the middle of them. |

- 3 *And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.* He said, "Truly I tell You, unless You change and become like little children, You will never enter the kingdom of heaven.
- 4 *Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven.* Whoever humbles himself like this child is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven.
- 5 *And whoso shall receive one such little child in my name receiveth me.* And whoever welcomes a little child like this in My name welcomes Me.
- 6 *But whoso shall offend one of these little ones which believe in me, it were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and that he were drowned in the depth of the sea.* But whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in Me to stumble — it would be better for Him to have a large millstone hung around His neck and be drowned in the depths of the sea.
- 7 *Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!* Woe to the world because of the things that cause people to stumble! Such things must come, but woe to the person through whom they come!
- 8 *Wherefore if thy hand or thy foot offend thee, cut them off, and cast them from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life halt or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into everlasting fire.* If Your hand or Your foot causes You to stumble, cut it off and throw it away. It is better to enter life lame or crippled than to have two hands or two feet and be thrown into everlasting fire.
- 9 *And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire.* If Your eye causes You to stumble, pluck it out and throw it away. It is better to enter life with one eye than to have two eyes and be thrown into hell fire.
- 10 *Take heed that ye despise not one of these little ones; for I say unto you, That in heaven their angels do always behold the face of my Father which is in heaven.* See that You do not look down on one of these little ones. I tell You that their angels in heaven always see the face of My Father in heaven.

- 11 *For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost.* The Son of Man came to save what was lost.
- 12 *How think ye? if a man have an hundred sheep, and one of them be gone astray, doth he not leave the ninety and nine, and goeth into the mountains, and seeketh that which is gone astray?* What do You think? If a man has a hundred sheep and one wanders away, will He not leave the ninety-nine on the hills and go to look for the one that wandered off?
- 13 *And if so be that he find it, verily I say unto you, he rejoiceth more of that sheep, than of the ninety and nine which went not astray.* If He finds it, truly I tell You, He is happier over that one sheep than over the ninety-nine that did not wander off.
- 14 *Even so it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.* In the same way, it is not the will of Your Father in heaven that any of these little ones should perish.
- 15 *Moreover if thy brother shall trespass against thee, go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone: if he shall hear thee, thou hast gained thy brother.* If Your brother sins against You, go and show Him His fault — just between the two of You. If He listens to You, You have won Your brother back.
- 16 *But if he will not hear thee, then take with thee one or two more, that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established.* But if He will not listen, take one or two others along, so that every matter may be confirmed by the testimony of two or three witnesses.
- 17 *And if he shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the church: but if he neglect to hear the church, let him be unto thee as an heathen man and a publican.* If He refuses to listen to them, tell it to the church. If He refuses to listen even to the church, treat Him as You would a pagan or a tax collector.
- 18 *Verily I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever ye shall loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.* Truly I tell You, whatever You bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever You loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.

- 19 *Again I say unto you, That if two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father which is in heaven.* Again, truly I tell You, if two of You on earth agree about anything You ask for, it will be done for You by My Father in heaven.
- 20 *For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.* For where two or three gather in My name, I am there with them."
- 21 *Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord, how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? till seven times?* Then Peter came to Jesus and asked, "Lord, how many times shall I forgive my brother when He sins against me? Up to seven times?"
- 22 *Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.* Jesus answered, "I tell You, not seven times, but seventy times seven.
- 23 *Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.* The kingdom of heaven is like a king who wanted to settle accounts with His servants.
- 24 *And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents.* As He began the accounting, a man who owed him ten thousand talents was brought to Him.
- 25 *But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.* Since He could not pay, the master ordered that He, his wife, His children, and all that He had be sold to repay the debt.
- 26 *The servant therefore fell down, and worshipped him, saying, Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.* The servant fell on his knees before him. "Be patient with me," he begged, "and I will pay back everything."
- 27 *Then the lord of that servant was moved with compassion, and loosed him, and forgave him the debt.* The servant's master felt compassion for him, released Him, and forgave the debt.

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| <p>28 <i>But the same servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and besought him, saying, Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt.</i></p> <p>31 <i>So when his fellowservants saw what was done, they were very sorry, and came and told unto their lord all that was done.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Then his lord, after that he had called him, said unto him, O thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all that debt, because thou desiredst me:</i></p> <p>33 <i>Shouldest not thou also have had compassion on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity on thee?</i></p> <p>34 <i>And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.</i></p> <p>35 <i>So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.</i></p> | <p>But when that same servant went out, He found one of His fellow servants who owed Him a hundred denarii. He grabbed Him and choked Him. "Pay back what You owe me!" he demanded.</p> <p>His fellow servant fell on His knees and begged Him, "Be patient with me, and I will pay You back."</p> <p>But he refused. He went and had the man thrown into prison until he could pay the debt.</p> <p>When the other servants saw what had happened, they were deeply distressed and told their master everything.</p> <p>Then the master called the servant in. "You wicked servant," he said, "I forgave all that debt of yours because you begged me.</p> <p>Should you not also have had mercy on your fellow servant, just as I had mercy on you?"</p> <p>In his anger, the master handed him over to the jailers to be tortured until he paid back all he owed.</p> <p>This is how My heavenly Father will treat each of you unless you forgive your brother from your heart."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

publican — A Jewish tax collector working for Rome — despised by fellow Jews as a traitor and swindler; also called 'tax collectors' in modern translations.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mark 9:33-37; Luke 9:46-48; Matt 20:20-28; Phil 2:3; Luke 22:24-27
v3 — Mark 10:14-15; 1 Pet 2:2; Matt 19:14; 1 Cor 14:20; Luke 18:16-17
v4 — Jas 4:10; Mark 10:43; Luke 14:11; Luke 9:48; Matt 23:11-12
v6 — Mark 9:42; Luke 17:1-2; Matt 18:10; 2 Thess 1:6-9; Matt 18:14
v10 — Ps 91:11; Ps 34:7; Heb 1:14; Luke 16:22; 2 Kgs 6:16-17
v12 — Ezek 34:12; Luke 15:4-7; Ezek 34:16; Isa 53:6; Ezek 34:28
v15 — Lev 19:17; Gal 6:1; Luke 17:3-4; Col 3:13; 2 Thess 3:15
v18 — Matt 16:19; 2 Cor 2:10; John 20:23; 1 Cor 5:4-5; Rev 3:7-8
v19 — Matt 7:7; 1 John 5:14-16; Mark 11:24; John 14:13-14; Phil 1:19
v20 — 1 Cor 5:4; Rev 21:3; Matt 28:20; Zech 2:5; John 20:26
v22 — Col 3:13; Mark 11:25; Eph 4:31-5:1; Matt 6:14-15; Gen 4:24
v35 — Matt 6:14-15; Jas 2:13; Luke 6:37-38; Mark 11:25; Matt 6:12

Chapter 19

Jesus teaches on marriage and divorce, blesses little children, and tells a rich young man to sell all he has and follow Him. The young man goes away sorrowful, and Jesus tells His disciples it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God.

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| 1 <i>And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these sayings, he departed from Galilee, and came into the coasts of Judaea beyond Jordan;</i> | When Jesus had finished saying these things, He left Galilee and went to the region of Judea on the other side of the Jordan. |
| 2 <i>And great multitudes followed him; and he healed them there.</i> | Large crowds followed Him, and He healed them there. |
| 3 <i>The Pharisees also came unto him, tempting him, and saying unto him, Is it lawful for a man to put away his wife for every cause?</i> | Some Pharisees came to test Him. They asked, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any reason?" |
| 4 <i>And he answered and said unto them, Have ye not read, that he which made them at the beginning made them male and female,</i> | He answered, "Have You not read that He who created them from the beginning made them male and female, |
| 5 <i>And said, For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife: and they twain shall be one flesh?</i> | and said, 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh'? |

- 6 *Wherefore they are no more twain, but one flesh. What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.* So they are no longer two, but one flesh. Therefore what God has joined together, let no man separate."
- 7 *They say unto him, Why did Moses then command to give a writing of divorcement, and to put her away?* "Why then," they asked, "did Moses command that a man give his wife a certificate of divorce and send her away?"
- 8 *He saith unto them, Moses because of the hardness of your hearts suffered you to put away your wives: but from the beginning it was not so.* Jesus replied, "Moses permitted you to divorce your wives because of Your hard hearts. But it was not this way from the beginning.
- 9 *And I say unto you, Whosoever shall put away his wife, except it be for fornication, and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery.* I tell You that whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another commits adultery."
- 10 *His disciples say unto him, If the case of the man be so with his wife, it is not good to marry.* The disciples said to Him, "If that is how it is between a husband and wife, it is better not to marry."
- 11 *But he said unto them, Not all men can receive this saying, save they to whom it is given.* Jesus replied, "Not everyone can accept this teaching — only those to whom it has been given.
- 12 *For there are some eunuchs, which were so born from their mother's womb: and there are some eunuchs, which were made eunuchs of men: and there be eunuchs, which have made themselves eunuchs for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.* Some are born without the ability to marry. Some are made that way by others. And some choose to live that way for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. Let the one who can accept this accept it."

- 13 *Then were there brought unto him little children, that he should put his hands on them, and pray: and the disciples rebuked them.* Then little children were brought to Jesus for Him to place His hands on them and pray. But the disciples rebuked those who brought them.
- 14 *But Jesus said, Suffer little children, and forbid them not, to come unto me: for of such is the kingdom of heaven.* Jesus said, "Let the little children come to Me and do not stop them. The kingdom of heaven belongs to such as these."
- 15 *And he laid his hands on them, and departed thence.* He placed His hands on them and then left from there.
- 16 *And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?* A man came to Jesus and asked, "Master, what good thing must I do to have eternal life?"
- 17 *And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.* Jesus said, "Why do You ask Me about what is good? There is only One who is good. If You want to enter life, keep the commandments."
- 18 *He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness,* "Which ones?" he asked. Jesus replied, "Do not murder, do not commit adultery, do not steal, do not give false testimony,
- 19 *Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.* honor Your father and mother, and love Your neighbor as Yourself."
- 20 *The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet?* The young man said, "I have kept all these. What do I still lack?"
- 21 *Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.* Jesus answered, "If You want to be perfect, go and sell what You own and give the money to the poor. You will have treasure in heaven. Then come and follow Me."

- 22 *But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions.* When the young man heard this, He went away sad, because He had great wealth.
- 23 *Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.* Then Jesus said to His disciples, "Truly I tell You, it is hard for a rich person to enter the kingdom of heaven.
- 24 *And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.* Again I tell You, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God."
- 25 *When his disciples heard it, they were exceeding amazed, saying, Who then can be saved?* When the disciples heard this, they were greatly astonished and asked, "Who then can be saved?"
- 26 *But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.* Jesus looked at them and said, "With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible."
- 27 *Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?* Peter answered him, "We have left everything to follow You! What then will there be for us?"
- 28 *And Jesus said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.* Jesus said to them, "Truly I tell You, at the renewal of all things, when the Son of Man sits on His glorious throne, You who have followed Me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.
- 29 *And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.* And everyone who has left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or wife or children or fields for My sake will receive a hundred times as much and will inherit eternal life.

- 30
- But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.*

But many who are first will be last, and many who are last will be first.

Words in this chapter:

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Gen 2:23; Gen 1:27; Gen 5:2; Luke 10:26; Mal 2:15
- v5 — Gen 2:21-24; 1 Cor 7:4; 1 Cor 7:2; Eph 5:31; Mark 10:5-9
- v6 — Mark 10:9; Heb 13:4; Rom 7:2; 1 Cor 7:10-14; Eph 5:28
- v9 — Matt 5:32; Luke 16:18; 1 Cor 7:39; 1 Cor 7:10-13; Mark 10:11-12
- v14 — Matt 18:3; Luke 18:16-17; 1 Cor 14:20; Mark 10:14; Matt 11:25
- v16 — Mark 10:17-30; Luke 18:18-30; John 3:15; Jude 1:21; Matt 25:46
- v21 — Mark 10:21; Luke 18:22; Luke 12:33; Acts 2:45; Luke 14:33
- v26 — Jer 32:27; Luke 1:37; Job 42:2; Mark 10:27; Luke 18:27
- v27 — Phil 3:8; Luke 18:28; Luke 5:11; Mark 1:17-20; Luke 15:29
- v28 — Luke 22:28-30; Matt 25:31; 1 Cor 6:2-3; Rev 20:4; Isa 65:17
- v29 — Luke 18:29-30; Mark 10:29-30; Phil 3:8; Luke 14:26; Matt 16:25
- v30 — Luke 13:30; Matt 20:16; Mark 10:31; Matt 21:31-32; Luke 18:13-14

Chapter 20

Jesus tells the parable of the laborers in the vineyard, where those hired last receive the same wage as those hired first. He foretells His crucifixion and resurrection a third time, rebukes the ambition of James and John's mother, and heals two blind men near Jericho.

- 1

For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.

The kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire workers for his vineyard.
- 2

And when he had agreed with the labourers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard.

He agreed to pay the workers a denarius for the day and sent them into his vineyard.
- 3

And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the marketplace,

About nine in the morning He went out and saw others standing idle in the marketplace.

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| 4 | <i>And said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right I will give you. And they went their way.</i> | He told them, "You also go and work in my vineyard, and I will pay You what is right." So they went. |
| 5 | <i>Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise.</i> | He went out again about noon and at three in the afternoon and did the same. |
| 6 | <i>And about the eleventh hour he went out, and found others standing idle, and saith unto them, Why stand ye here all the day idle?</i> | About five in the afternoon He went out and found still others standing around. He asked them, "Why have You been standing here all day doing nothing?" |
| 7 | <i>They say unto him, Because no man hath hired us. He saith unto them, Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive.</i> | "Because no one has hired us," they answered. He said to them, "You also go and work in my vineyard." |
| 8 | <i>So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward, Call the labourers, and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first.</i> | When evening came, the owner of the vineyard said to His foreman, "Call the workers and pay them their wages, beginning with the last ones hired and going on to the first." |
| 9 | <i>And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny.</i> | The workers hired about five in the afternoon came, and each received a denarius. |
| 10 | <i>But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny.</i> | When the workers hired first came, they expected to receive more. But each of them also received a denarius. |
| 11 | <i>And when they had received it, they murmured against the goodman of the house,</i> | When they received it, they grumbled against the landowner. |

- 12 *Saying, These last have wrought but one hour, and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and heat of the day.* "These workers hired last worked only one hour," they said, "and You have made them equal to us who have borne the burden and heat of the day."
- 13 *But he answered one of them, and said, Friend, I do thee no wrong: didst not thou agree with me for a penny?* He answered one of them, "Friend, I am not treating You unfairly. Didn't You agree to work for a denarius?"
- 14 *Take that thine is, and go thy way: I will give unto this last, even as unto thee.* Take Your pay and go. I want to give the last worker hired the same as I gave You.
- 15 *Is it not lawful for me to do what I will with mine own? Is thine eye evil, because I am good?* Don't I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are You envious because I am generous?"
- 16 *So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called, but few chosen.* So the last will be first, and the first will be last. For many are called, but few are chosen."
- 17 *And Jesus going up to Jerusalem took the twelve disciples apart in the way, and said unto them,* As Jesus was going up to Jerusalem, He took the twelve disciples aside and said to them,
- 18 *Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be betrayed unto the chief priests and unto the scribes, and they shall condemn him to death,* "We are going up to Jerusalem. The Son of Man will be handed over to the chief priests and the scribes. They will condemn Him to death
- 19 *And shall deliver him to the Gentiles to mock, and to scourge, and to crucify him: and the third day he shall rise again.* and hand Him over to the Gentiles to be mocked, flogged, and crucified. On the third day He will be raised to life."
- 20 *Then came to him the mother of Zebedee's children with her sons, worshipping him, and desiring a certain thing of him.* Then the mother of Zebedee's sons came to Jesus with her sons. She knelt down and asked something of Him.

- 21 *And he said unto her, What wilt thou? She saith unto him, Grant that these my two sons may sit, the one on thy right hand, and the other on the left, in thy kingdom.* "What do You want?" He asked. She said, "Grant that one of these two sons of mine may sit at Your right hand and the other at Your left in Your kingdom."
- 22 *But Jesus answered and said, Ye know not what ye ask. Are ye able to drink of the cup that I shall drink of, and to be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with? They say unto him, We are able.* Jesus replied, "You don't know what You are asking. Can You drink the cup I am going to drink?" "We can," they answered.
- 23 *And he saith unto them, Ye shall drink indeed of my cup, and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with: but to sit on my right hand, and on my left, is not mine to give, but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared of my Father.* Jesus said to them, "You will indeed drink from My cup. But to sit at My right or left is not Mine to grant — it belongs to those for whom it has been prepared by My Father."
- 24 *And when the ten heard it, they were moved with indignation against the two brethren.* When the other ten disciples heard about this, they were indignant at the two brothers.
- 25 *But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Ye know that the princes of the Gentiles exercise dominion over them, and they that are great exercise authority upon them.* Jesus called them together and said, "You know that the rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their high officials exercise authority over them.
- 26 *But it shall not be so among you: but whosoever will be great among you, let him be your minister;* It is not to be that way with You. Whoever wants to be great among you must be your servant,
- 27 *And whosoever will be chief among you, let him be your servant:* and whoever wants to be first must be your slave —
- 28 *Even as the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.* just as the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give His life as a ransom for many."

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| 29 | <i>And as they departed from Jericho, a great multitude followed him.</i> | As they were leaving Jericho, a large crowd followed Him. |
| 30 | <i>And, behold, two blind men sitting by the way side, when they heard that Jesus passed by, cried out, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.</i> | Two blind men were sitting by the roadside, and when they heard that Jesus was passing by, they cried out, "Lord, Son of David, have mercy on us!" |
| 31 | <i>And the multitude rebuked them, because they should hold their peace: but they cried the more, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.</i> | The crowd rebuked them and told them to be quiet, but they cried out all the louder, "Lord, Son of David, have mercy on us!" |
| 32 | <i>And Jesus stood still, and called them, and said, What will ye that I shall do unto you?</i> | Jesus stopped and called them. "What do You want Me to do for You?" He asked. |
| 33 | <i>They say unto him, Lord, that our eyes may be opened.</i> | "Lord," they answered, "we want our eyes to be opened." |
| 34 | <i>So Jesus had compassion on them, and touched their eyes: and immediately their eyes received sight, and they followed him.</i> | Jesus felt compassion for them and touched their eyes. Immediately they could see, and they followed Him. |

Words in this chapter:

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 13:24; Matt 13:47; Heb 13:21; Matt 22:2; 1 Cor 15:58
v13 — Matt 26:50; Matt 22:12; Rom 9:14-15
v15 — Rom 9:15-24; Deut 15:9; Matt 6:23; Jonah 4:1-4; Mark 7:22
v16 — Matt 19:30; Mark 10:31; Matt 22:14; Luke 13:28-30; Luke 15:7
v21 — Matt 19:28; Mark 10:36-37; Esth 5:3; Ps 110:1; 1 Kgs 3:5
v22 — Luke 22:42; Matt 26:42; Mark 14:36; John 18:11; Matt 26:39
v23 — Matt 25:34; Rev 1:9; Mark 10:40; Acts 12:2; 2 Tim 2:11-12
v25 — Luke 22:25-27; Matt 20:25-28; John 13:12-17; Mark 10:42; Matt 18:3-4
v26 — Mark 10:43; Mark 9:35; 1 Pet 5:3; Mark 10:45; Luke 18:14

v28 — Luke 22:27; Heb 9:28; Titus 2:14; 1 Pet 3:18; Phil 2:4-8

v29 — Mark 10:46-52; Luke 18:35-43

v34 — Matt 9:29; Ps 145:8; Heb 4:15-16; Luke 22:51; Acts 26:18

Chapter 21

Jesus enters Jerusalem riding on a donkey as crowds cry 'Hosanna to the Son of David.' He drives out the money changers from the temple, curses a fig tree that withers, and challenges the chief priests and elders with the parables of the two sons and the wicked husbandmen.

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| 1 <i>And when they drew nigh unto Jerusalem, and were come to Bethphage, unto the mount of Olives, then sent Jesus two disciples,</i> | When they approached Jerusalem and came to Bethphage on the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples ahead. |
| 2 <i>Saying unto them, Go into the village over against you, and straightway ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt with her: loose them, and bring them unto me.</i> | He said to them, "Go into the village ahead of You, and at once You will find a donkey tied there, with her colt beside her. Untie them and bring them to Me. |
| 3 <i>And if any man say ought unto you, ye shall say, The Lord hath need of them; and straightway he will send them.</i> | If anyone says anything to you, tell him that the Lord needs them, and He will send them right away." |
| 4 <i>All this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying,</i> | This took place to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet: |
| 5 <i>Tell ye the daughter of Sion, Behold, thy King cometh unto thee, meek, and sitting upon an ass, and a colt the foal of an ass.</i> | "Tell the daughter of Zion, 'See, your King comes to you, gentle and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.'" |
| 6 <i>And the disciples went, and did as Jesus commanded them,</i> | The disciples went and did as Jesus had instructed them. |
| 7 <i>And brought the ass, and the colt, and put on them their clothes, and they set him thereon.</i> | They brought the donkey and the colt, placed their cloaks on them, and Jesus sat on them. |

- 8 *And a very great multitude spread their garments in the way; others cut down branches from the trees, and strawed them in the way.* A very large crowd spread their cloaks on the road, while others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road.
- 9 *And the multitudes that went before, and that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna to the Son of David: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord; Hosanna in the highest.* The crowds that went ahead of Him and those that followed shouted, "Hosanna to the Son of David! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!"
- 10 *And when he was come into Jerusalem, all the city was moved, saying, Who is this?* When Jesus entered Jerusalem, the whole city was stirred and asked, "Who is this?"
- 11 *And the multitude said, This is Jesus the prophet of Nazareth of Galilee.* The crowds answered, "This is Jesus, the prophet from Nazareth in Galilee."
- 12 *And Jesus went into the temple of God, and cast out all them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves,* Jesus entered the temple of God and drove out all who were buying and selling there. He overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those selling doves.
- 13 *And said unto them, It is written, My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.* He said to them, "It is written, 'My house will be called a house of prayer,' but You have made it a den of thieves."
- 14 *And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.* The blind and the lame came to Him at the temple, and He healed them.
- 15 *And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the Son of David; they were sore displeased,* But when the chief priests and the scribes saw the wonderful things He did, and the children crying out in the temple, "Hosanna to the Son of David," they were indignant.

- 16 *And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say? And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?* "Do You hear what these children are saying?" they asked Him. "Yes," Jesus replied. "Have You never read, 'From the mouths of children and infants You have ordained praise'?"
- 17 *And he left them, and went out of the city into Bethany; and he lodged there.* He left them and went out of the city to Bethany, where He stayed that night.
- 18 *Now in the morning as he returned into the city, he hungered.* Early in the morning, as He was returning to the city, He was hungry.
- 19 *And when he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, Let no fruit grow on thee henceforward for ever. And presently the fig tree withered away.* Seeing a fig tree by the road, He went up to it but found nothing on it except leaves. He said to it, "May You never bear fruit again!" At once the fig tree withered.
- 20 *And when the disciples saw it, they marvelled, saying, How soon is the fig tree withered away!* When the disciples saw this, they were amazed. "How did the fig tree wither so quickly?" they asked.
- 21 *Jesus answered and said unto them, Verily I say unto you, If ye have faith, and doubt not, ye shall not only do this which is done to the fig tree, but also if ye shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; it shall be done.* Jesus replied, "Truly I tell You, if You have faith and do not doubt, You can do not only what was done to the fig tree, but also say to this mountain, 'Be lifted up and thrown into the sea,' and it will be done.
- 22 *And all things, whatsoever ye shall ask in prayer, believing, ye shall receive.* Whatever You ask for in prayer, if You believe, You will receive."
- 23 *And when he was come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came unto him as he was teaching, and said, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority?* Jesus entered the temple, and while He was teaching, the chief priests and the elders of the people came to him. "By what authority are you doing these things?" they asked. "And who gave You this authority?"

- 24 *And Jesus answered and said unto them, I also will ask you one thing, which if ye tell me, I in like wise will tell you by what authority I do these things.* Jesus replied, "I will also ask You one question. If You answer Me, I will tell You by what authority I do these things.
- 25 *The baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven, or of men? And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him?* John's baptism — where did it come from? From heaven, or from men?" They discussed it among themselves and said, "If we say, 'From heaven,' He will ask, 'Then why didn't You believe Him?'"
- 26 *But if we shall say, Of men; we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet.* But if we say, 'From men,' we are afraid of the people, for they all regard John as a prophet."
- 27 *And they answered Jesus, and said, We cannot tell. And he said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these things.* So they answered Jesus, "We don't know." He said to them, "Neither will I tell You by what authority I am doing these things.
- 28 *But what think ye? A certain man had two sons; and he came to the first, and said, Son, go work to day in my vineyard.* What do You think? A man had two sons. He went to the first and said, 'Son, go and work in the vineyard today.'
- 29 *He answered and said, I will not: but afterward he repented, and went.* 'I will not,' he answered, but later He changed His mind and went.
- 30 *And he came to the second, and said likewise. And he answered and said, I go, sir: and went not.* The father went to the second son and said the same. He answered, 'I will, sir,' but He did not go.
- 31 *Whether of them twain did the will of his father? They say unto him, The first. Jesus saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That the publicans and the harlots go into the kingdom of God before you.* Which of the two did the will of His father?" "The first," they answered. Jesus said to them, "Truly I tell You, the tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering the kingdom of God ahead of You.

- 32 *For John came unto you in the way of righteousness, and ye believed him not: but the publicans and the harlots believed him: and ye, when ye had seen it, repented not afterward, that ye might believe him.* For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you did not believe Him. But the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed Him. And even after You saw this, You did not repent and believe Him.
- 33 *Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country:* Listen to another parable. There was a landowner who planted a vineyard. He put a wall around it, dug a pit for the winepress, and built a watchtower. Then He rented the vineyard to some farmers and went away on a journey.
- 34 *And when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it.* When harvest time approached, He sent His servants to the farmers to collect his share of the fruit.
- 35 *And the husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another.* But the farmers seized His servants. They beat one, killed another, and stoned a third.
- 36 *Again, he sent other servants more than the first: and they did unto them likewise.* Then He sent more servants than the first group, and they treated them the same way.
- 37 *But last of all he sent unto them his son, saying, They will reverence my son.* Last of all, He sent His son to them. "They will respect my son," he said.
- 38 *But when the husbandmen saw the son, they said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and let us seize on his inheritance.* But when the farmers saw the son, they said to each other, "This is the heir. Come, let us kill Him and take His inheritance."
- 39 *And they caught him, and cast him out of the vineyard, and slew him.* So they seized Him, threw Him out of the vineyard, and killed Him.
- 40 *When the lord therefore of the vineyard cometh, what will he do unto those husbandmen?* Therefore, when the owner of the vineyard comes, what will He do to those farmers?"

- 41 *They say unto him, He will miserably destroy those wicked men, and will let out his vineyard unto other husbandmen, which shall render him the fruits in their seasons.* "He will bring those wretches to a wretched end," they replied, "and He will rent the vineyard to other farmers who will give Him His share at harvest time."
- 42 *Jesus saith unto them, Did ye never read in the scriptures, The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner: this is the Lord's doing, and it is marvellous in our eyes?* Jesus said to them, "Have You never read in the Scriptures: 'The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone. The Lord has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes'?"
- 43 *Therefore say I unto you, The kingdom of God shall be taken from you, and given to a nation bringing forth the fruits thereof.* Therefore I tell You that the kingdom of God will be taken from You and given to a people who will produce its fruit.
- 44 *And whosoever shall fall on this stone shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.* Whoever falls on this stone will be broken to pieces, and it will crush anyone it falls on."
- 45 *And when the chief priests and Pharisees had heard his parables, they perceived that he spake of them.* When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard His parables, they knew He was speaking about them.
- 46 *But when they sought to lay hands on him, they feared the multitude, because they took him for a prophet.* They looked for a way to arrest Him, but they were afraid of the crowd, because the people regarded him as a prophet.

Words in this chapter:

Hosanna (*ho-ZAN-ah*) — Hebrew cry meaning 'Save us, we pray!' — used as a shout of praise and welcome for the coming King.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

v4 — Zech 9:9; John 12:15; Matt 1:22

v5 — Zech 9:9-10; Isa 62:11; Isa 12:6; Isa 9:6-7; Gen 49:10

v9 — Ps 118:24-26; Luke 2:14; John 12:13-15; Matt 23:39; Luke 19:37-38

v12 — John 2:14-17; Luke 19:45-47; Mark 11:15-18; Lev 1:14; Lev 5:7
v13 — Jer 7:11; Isa 56:7; Luke 19:46; Mark 11:17; Ps 93:5
v16 — Ps 8:2; Matt 11:25; Luke 19:39-40; Matt 19:4; Matt 12:3
v19 — Mark 11:14; John 15:6; Titus 1:16; Luke 3:9; Luke 13:6-9
v21 — Jas 1:6; Matt 17:20; Mark 11:22-23; Luke 17:6-7; Rom 4:19-20
v22 — Matt 7:7; 1 John 5:14-15; Mark 11:24; 1 John 3:22; John 14:13
v42 — Ps 118:22-23; Isa 28:16; Acts 4:11; 1 Pet 2:4-8; Eph 2:20
v43 — Matt 21:41; Matt 8:11-12; 1 Pet 2:9; John 3:3; Luke 17:20-21
v44 — Isa 8:14-15; 1 Pet 2:8; Dan 2:34-35; Dan 2:44-45; Rom 9:33

Chapter 22

Jesus tells the parable of the marriage feast, where those first invited refuse to come and the king sends his servants into the highways. The Pharisees, Sadducees, and Herodians test Him with questions about paying tribute to Caesar, the resurrection, and the greatest commandment.

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| 1 | <i>And Jesus answered and spake unto them again by parables, and said,</i> | Jesus spoke to them again in parables, saying, |
| 2 | <i>The kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage for his son,</i> | "The kingdom of heaven is like a king who prepared a wedding banquet for His son. |
| 3 | <i>And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding: and they would not come.</i> | He sent His servants to call those who had been invited to the banquet, but they refused to come. |
| 4 | <i>Again, he sent forth other servants, saying, Tell them which are bidden, Behold, I have prepared my dinner: my oxen and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready: come unto the marriage.</i> | Then He sent more servants and said, 'Tell those who have been invited that I have prepared my dinner. My oxen and fattened cattle have been slaughtered, and everything is ready. Come to the wedding banquet.' |
| 5 | <i>But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise:</i> | But they paid no attention and went away — one to His field, another to His business. |
| 6 | <i>And the remnant took his servants, and entreated them spitefully, and slew them.</i> | The rest seized His servants, mistreated them, and killed them. |

- 7 *But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city.* The king was enraged. He sent his army and destroyed those murderers and burned their city.
- 8 *Then saith he to his servants, The wedding is ready, but they which were bidden were not worthy.* Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding banquet is ready, but those I invited were not worthy.'
- 9 *Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage.* Go to the street corners and invite anyone you find to the banquet.'
- 10 *So those servants went out into the highways, and gathered together all as many as they found, both bad and good: and the wedding was furnished with guests.* So the servants went out into the streets and gathered all the people they could find, both bad and good. The wedding hall was filled with guests.
- 11 *And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment:* But when the king came in to see the guests, he noticed a man there who was not wearing wedding clothes.
- 12 *And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.* "Friend," he asked, "how did you get in here without wedding clothes?" The man had no answer.
- 13 *Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.* Then the king told the servants, "Tie him hand and foot and throw him into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."
- 14 *For many are called, but few are chosen.* For many are called, but few are chosen."
- 15 *Then went the Pharisees, and took counsel how they might entangle him in his talk.* Then the Pharisees went out and made plans to trap Jesus in His words.

- 16 *And they sent out unto him their disciples with the Herodians, saying, Master, we know that thou art true, and teachest the way of God in truth, neither carest thou for any man: for thou regardest not the person of men.* They sent their disciples to Him along with the Herodians. "Master," they said, "we know You are a man of integrity and that you teach the way of God truthfully. You are not influenced by others, because You pay no attention to who they are.
- 17 *Tell us therefore, What thinkest thou? Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar, or not?* Tell us then, what is Your opinion? Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?"
- 18 *But Jesus perceived their wickedness, and said, Why tempt ye me, ye hypocrites?* But Jesus, knowing their evil intent, said, "You hypocrites, why are You trying to trap Me?"
- 19 *Shew me the tribute money. And they brought unto him a penny.* Show Me the coin used for paying the tax." They brought Him a denarius.
- 20 *And he saith unto them, Whose is this image and superscription?* He asked them, "Whose image is this, and whose inscription?"
- 21 *They say unto him, Caesar's. Then saith he unto them, Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things that are God's.* "Caesar's," they replied. He said to them, "Give to Caesar what is Caesar's, and give to God what is God's."
- 22 *When they had heard these words, they marvelled, and left him, and went their way.* When they heard this, they were amazed. They left Him and went away.
- 23 *The same day came to him the Sadducees, which say that there is no resurrection, and asked him,* That same day the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to Him with a question.
- 24 *Saying, Master, Moses said, If a man die, having no children, his brother shall marry his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.* "Master," they said, "Moses told us that if a man dies without children, his brother must marry the widow and have children for him.

- 25 *Now there were with us seven brethren: and the first, when he had married a wife, deceased, and, having no issue, left his wife unto his brother:* Now there were seven brothers among us. The first one married and died, and since he had no children, he left his wife to his brother.
- 26 *Likewise the second also, and the third, unto the seventh.* The same thing happened to the second and third brother, right on down to the seventh.
- 27 *And last of all the woman died also.* Last of all, the woman died.
- 28 *Therefore in the resurrection whose wife shall she be of the seven? for they all had her.* So then, at the resurrection, whose wife will she be of the seven? They all had her."
- 29 *Jesus answered and said unto them, Ye do err, not knowing the scriptures, nor the power of God.* Jesus replied, "You are wrong because You know neither the Scriptures nor the power of God.
- 30 *For in the resurrection they neither marry, nor are given in marriage, but are as the angels of God in heaven.* At the resurrection, people will neither marry nor be given in marriage. They will be like the angels in heaven.
- 31 *But as touching the resurrection of the dead, have ye not read that which was spoken unto you by God, saying,* But about the resurrection of the dead — have You not read what God said to You:
- 32 *I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob? God is not the God of the dead, but of the living.* 'I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob'? He is not the God of the dead but of the living."
- 33 *And when the multitude heard this, they were astonished at his doctrine.* When the crowd heard this, they were astonished at His teaching.
- 34 *But when the Pharisees had heard that he had put the Sadducees to silence, they were gathered together.* When the Pharisees heard that He had silenced the Sadducees, they came together.
- 35 *Then one of them, which was a lawyer, asked him a question, tempting him, and saying,* One of them, a lawyer, tested Him with this question:
- 36 *Master, which is the great commandment in the law?* "Master, which is the greatest commandment in the Law?"

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| 37 <i>Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.</i> | Jesus replied, "Love the Lord Your God with all Your heart and with all Your soul and with all Your mind. |
| 38 <i>This is the first and great commandment.</i> | This is the first and greatest commandment. |
| 39 <i>And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.</i> | And the second is like it: Love Your neighbor as Yourself. |
| 40 <i>On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.</i> | All the Law and the Prophets hang on these two commandments." |
| 41 <i>While the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them,</i> | While the Pharisees were gathered, Jesus asked them, |
| 42 <i>Saying, What think ye of Christ? whose son is he? They say unto him, The son of David.</i> | "What do You think about the Christ? Whose son is He?" "The son of David," they replied. |
| 43 <i>He saith unto them, How then doth David in spirit call him Lord, saying,</i> | He said to them, "How is it then that David, speaking by the Spirit, calls Him 'Lord'? For He says, |
| 44 <i>The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool?</i> | "The LORD said to my Lord, "Sit at My right hand until I put Your enemies under Your feet." |
| 45 <i>If David then call him Lord, how is he his son?</i> | If then David calls him 'Lord,' how can he be his son?" |
| 46 <i>And no man was able to answer him a word, neither durst any man from that day forth ask him any more questions.</i> | No one could answer him a word, and from that day on no one dared to question him any further. |

Words in this chapter:

Sadducees (*SAD-yoo-seez*) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v11 — Rev 19:8; Rev 3:4-5; Zech 3:3-4; Heb 4:12-13; Col 3:10-11
- v12 — Matt 20:13; 1 Sam 2:9; Job 5:16; Matt 26:50; Acts 5:2-11
- v14 — 2 Pet 1:10; Luke 13:23-24; Rev 17:14; Matt 7:13-14; Matt 20:16
- v21 — Rom 13:7; Prov 24:21; Acts 4:19; Mal 1:6-8; 1 Pet 2:13-17
- v29 — John 20:9; Rom 15:4; Luke 1:37; Dan 12:2-3; Jer 32:17
- v30 — Luke 20:34-36; Mark 12:24-25
- v32 — Ex 3:6; Mark 12:26-27; Luke 20:37-38; Acts 7:32; Ex 3:15-16
- v36 — Mark 12:28-33; Matt 5:19-20; Luke 11:42; Matt 23:23-24
- v37 — Mark 12:29-30; Luke 10:27; Deut 6:5; Deut 10:12; Mark 12:33
- v39 — Mark 12:31; Luke 10:27-37; Lev 19:18; Rom 13:9-10; Gal 5:14
- v40 — Rom 13:9; Matt 7:12; 1 John 4:19-21; Jas 2:8; 1 John 4:7-11
- v44 — Ps 110:1; Heb 1:13; Acts 2:34-35; 1 Cor 15:25; Heb 10:12-13

Chapter 23

Jesus pronounces seven woes on the scribes and Pharisees, calling them hypocrites, blind guides, and whitewashed tombs. He laments over Jerusalem, declaring that her house is left desolate and that she will not see Him again until she says, 'Blessed is He that comes in the name of the Lord.'

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| 1 | <i>Then spake Jesus to the multitude, and to his disciples,</i> | Then Jesus spoke to the crowd and to His disciples. |
| 2 | <i>Saying, The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses' seat:</i> | He said, "The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses' seat. |
| 3 | <i>All therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do; but do not ye after their works: for they say, and do not.</i> | So practice and obey everything they tell you. But do not follow their example, because they do not practice what they teach. |
| 4 | <i>For they bind heavy burdens and grievous to be borne, and lay them on men's shoulders; but they themselves will not move them with one of their fingers.</i> | They tie up heavy loads and put them on other people's shoulders, but they themselves are not willing to lift a finger to move them. |
| 5 | <i>But all their works they do for to be seen of men: they make broad their phylacteries, and enlarge the borders of their garments,</i> | Everything they do is done for people to see. They make their phylacteries wide and the tassels on their garments long. |

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| <p>6 <i>And love the uppermost rooms at feasts, and the chief seats in the synagogues,</i></p> <p>7 <i>And greetings in the markets, and to be called of men, Rabbi, Rabbi.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, even Christ; and all ye are brethren.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Neither be ye called masters: for one is your Master, even Christ.</i></p> <p>11 <i>But he that is greatest among you shall be your servant.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And whosoever shall exalt himself shall be abased; and he that shall humble himself shall be exalted.</i></p> <p>13 <i>But woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye shut up the kingdom of heaven against men: for ye neither go in yourselves, neither suffer ye them that are entering to go in.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye devour widows' houses, and for a pretence make long prayer: therefore ye shall receive the greater damnation.</i></p> | <p>They love the place of honor at banquets and the most important seats in the synagogues.</p> <p>They love to be greeted with respect in the marketplaces and to be called 'Rabbi' by others.</p> <p>But you are not to be called 'Rabbi,' for you have one Master, and you are all brothers.</p> <p>And do not call anyone on earth 'father,' for you have one Father, and He is in heaven.</p> <p>Nor are You to be called 'Master,' for You have one Master — the Christ.</p> <p>The greatest among You will be Your servant.</p> <p>Whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted.</p> <p>Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You shut the kingdom of heaven in people's faces. You yourselves do not enter, and You block those who are trying to enter.</p> <p>Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You devour widows' houses and for appearance make long prayers. Therefore You will receive the greater damnation.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. The KJV uses "damnation" and "damned" where some modern translations say "judgment" or "condemnation." The KJV word is stronger — it points to the ultimate, irreversible verdict of God against unrepentant sin.

- 15 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye compass sea and land to make one proselyte, and when he is made, ye make him twofold more the child of hell than yourselves.* Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You travel over land and sea to win a single convert, and when You have won Him, You make Him twice as much a child of hell as You are.
- 16 *Woe unto you, ye blind guides, which say, Whosoever shall swear by the temple, it is nothing; but whosoever shall swear by the gold of the temple, he is a debtor!* Woe to You, blind guides! You say, "If anyone swears by the temple, it means nothing. But if anyone swears by the gold of the temple, he is bound by His oath."
- 17 *Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold?* You blind fools! Which is greater: the gold, or the temple that makes the gold sacred?
- 18 *And, Whosoever shall swear by the altar, it is nothing; but whosoever sweareth by the gift that is upon it, he is guilty.* You also say, "If anyone swears by the altar, it means nothing. But if anyone swears by the gift on the altar, he is bound by His oath."
- 19 *Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift?* You blind men! Which is greater: the gift, or the altar that makes the gift sacred?
- 20 *Whoso therefore shall swear by the altar, sweareth by it, and by all things thereon.* Therefore, whoever swears by the altar swears by it and by everything on it.
- 21 *And whoso shall swear by the temple, sweareth by it, and by him that dwelleth therein.* Whoever swears by the temple swears by it and by the One who lives in it.
- 22 *And he that shall swear by heaven, sweareth by the throne of God, and by him that sitteth thereon.* And whoever swears by heaven swears by the throne of God and by the One who sits on it.

- 23 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye pay tithe of mint and anise and cummin, and have omitted the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.* Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You give a tenth of Your spices — mint, anise, and cumin. But You have neglected the more important matters of the law: judgment, mercy, and faith. You should have practiced these without neglecting the others.
- 24 *Ye blind guides, which strain at a gnat, and swallow a camel.* You blind guides! You strain out a gnat but swallow a camel.
- 25 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye make clean the outside of the cup and of the platter, but within they are full of extortion and excess.* Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You clean the outside of the cup and dish, but inside they are full of greed and self-indulgence.
- 26 *Thou blind Pharisee, cleanse first that which is within the cup and platter, that the outside of them may be clean also.* Blind Pharisee! First clean the inside of the cup and dish, and then the outside will also be clean.
- 27 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye are like unto whited sepulchres, which indeed appear beautiful outward, but are within full of dead men's bones, and of all uncleanness.* Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You are like whitewashed tombs, which look beautiful on the outside but on the inside are full of dead men's bones and everything unclean.
- 28 *Even so ye also outwardly appear righteous unto men, but within ye are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.* In the same way, on the outside You appear righteous to others, but on the inside You are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.
- 29 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! because ye build the tombs of the prophets, and garnish the sepulchres of the righteous,* Woe to You, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! You build tombs for the prophets and decorate the graves of the righteous.

- 30 *And say, If we had been in the days of our fathers, we would not have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.* You say, "If we had lived in the days of our ancestors, we would not have taken part in shedding the blood of the prophets."
- 31 *Wherefore ye be witnesses unto yourselves, that ye are the children of them which killed the prophets.* By saying this, You testify against yourselves that You are the descendants of those who murdered the prophets.
- 32 *Fill ye up then the measure of your fathers.* Go ahead, then, and complete what Your ancestors started!
- 33 *Ye serpents, ye generation of vipers, how can ye escape the damnation of hell?* You snakes! You brood of vipers! How will You escape the damnation of hell?
- 34 *Wherefore, behold, I send unto you prophets, and wise men, and scribes: and some of them ye shall kill and crucify; and some of them shall ye scourge in your synagogues, and persecute them from city to city:* Therefore I am sending You prophets and wise men and teachers. Some of them You will kill and crucify. Others You will flog in Your synagogues and pursue from town to town.
- 35 *That upon you may come all the righteous blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom ye slew between the temple and the altar.* So on you will come all the righteous blood shed on earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom you murdered between the temple and the altar.
- 36 *Verily I say unto you, All these things shall come upon this generation.* Truly I tell you, all this will come on this generation.
- 37 *O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them which are sent unto thee, how often would I have gathered thy children together, even as a hen gathereth her chickens under her wings, and ye would not!* Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kill the prophets and stone those sent to you! How often I have longed to gather your children together, as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, and you were not willing!

- 38 *Behold, your house is left unto you desolate.* Your house is left to you desolate.
- 39 *For I say unto you, Ye shall not see me henceforth, till ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.* For I tell you, you will not see Me again until you say, "Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord."

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

phylacteries (*fih-LAK-ter-eez*) — Small leather boxes containing Scripture verses, strapped to the forehead and arm during prayer — a Jewish practice based on Deuteronomy 6:8.

Abel (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Zacharias (*zak-ah-RY-as*) — A priest and the father of John the Baptist — struck mute when he doubted the angel's announcement; his name means 'the LORD remembers.'

Cross-References:

- v4** — Luke 11:46; Acts 15:10; Gal 6:13; Matt 11:28-30
v5 — Matt 6:1-16; John 12:43; Phil 2:3; John 5:44; Deut 6:8
v8 — Jas 3:1; 1 Cor 1:12-13; 1 Pet 5:3; Luke 22:32; Matt 17:5
v9 — 1 John 3:1; Heb 12:9; Mal 1:6; Job 32:21-22; Rom 8:14-17
v11 — 1 Cor 9:19; John 13:14-15; Gal 5:13; Mark 10:43-44; 2 Cor 4:5
v12 — Jas 4:6; 1 Pet 5:5; Luke 14:11; Prov 29:23; Matt 18:4
v13 — Luke 11:52; Matt 23:29; Matt 23:23; Matt 23:27; Zech 11:17
v23 — Luke 11:42; Mic 6:8; Matt 9:13; Hos 6:6; Matt 5:19-20
v26 — 2 Cor 7:1; Heb 10:22; Jas 4:8; Ezek 18:31; Isa 55:7
v33 — Matt 3:7; Matt 12:34; Matt 5:22; John 8:44; Luke 3:7
v35 — 2 Chr 24:20-22; Heb 11:4; Zech 1:1; Gen 4:8; Rev 18:24
v37 — Luke 13:34-35; Ps 91:4; Ruth 2:12; Deut 32:11-12; Ps 17:8

Chapter 24

Jesus foretells the destruction of the temple and the signs of His second coming, including wars, famines, false prophets, and the abomination of desolation. He warns His disciples to watch and be ready, for the Son of man will come at an hour they do not expect.

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| 1 <i>And Jesus went out, and departed from the temple: and his disciples came to him for to shew him the buildings of the temple.</i> | Jesus left the temple and was walking away when His disciples came up to point out the temple buildings to Him. |
| 2 <i>And Jesus said unto them, See ye not all these things? verily I say unto you, There shall not be left here one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.</i> | He said to them, "Do You see all these things? Truly I tell You, not one stone here will be left on another — every one will be thrown down." |
| 3 <i>And as he sat upon the mount of Olives, the disciples came unto him privately, saying, Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?</i> | As Jesus was sitting on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to Him privately. "Tell us," they said, "when will this happen? And what will be the sign of Your coming and of the end of the world?" |
| 4 <i>And Jesus answered and said unto them, Take heed that no man deceive you.</i> | Jesus answered, "Watch out that no one deceives you. |
| 5 <i>For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.</i> | Many will come in My name, claiming, 'I am the Christ,' and will deceive many. |
| 6 <i>And ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars: see that ye be not troubled: for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet.</i> | You will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that You are not alarmed. Such things must happen, but the end is still to come. |
| 7 <i>For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be famines, and pestilences, and earthquakes, in divers places.</i> | Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be famines and earthquakes in various places. |
| 8 <i>All these are the beginning of sorrows.</i> | All these are the beginning of sorrows. |

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| 9 <i>Then shall they deliver you up to be afflicted, and shall kill you: and ye shall be hated of all nations for my name's sake.</i> | Then You will be handed over to be persecuted and put to death. You will be hated by all nations because of Me. |
| 10 <i>And then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.</i> | At that time many will fall away. They will betray one another and hate one another. |
| 11 <i>And many false prophets shall rise, and shall deceive many.</i> | Many false prophets will appear and deceive many people. |
| 12 <i>And because iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.</i> | Because iniquity will increase, the love of most will grow cold. |
| 13 <i>But he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.</i> | But the one who stands firm to the end will be saved. |
| 14 <i>And this gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world for a witness unto all nations; and then shall the end come.</i> | And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in the whole world as a testimony to all nations, and then the end will come. |
| 15 <i>When ye therefore shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)</i> | So when you see the abomination of desolation, spoken of through the prophet Daniel, standing in the holy place — let the reader understand — |
| 16 <i>Then let them which be in Judaea flee into the mountains:</i> | then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains. |
| 17 <i>Let him which is on the housetop not come down to take any thing out of his house:</i> | Let no one on the housetop go down to take anything out of the house. |
| 18 <i>Neither let him which is in the field return back to take his clothes.</i> | Let no one in the field go back to get his cloak. |
| 19 <i>And woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!</i> | Woe to pregnant women and nursing mothers in those days! |

- 20 *But pray ye that your flight be not in the winter, neither on the sabbath day:* Pray that your flight will not take place in winter or on the Sabbath.
- 21 *For then shall be great tribulation, such as was not since the beginning of the world to this time, no, nor ever shall be.* For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been from the beginning of the world until now — and never will be again.
- 22 *And except those days should be shortened, there should no flesh be saved: but for the elect's sake those days shall be shortened.* If those days had not been cut short, no one would survive. But for the sake of the elect, those days will be shortened.
- 23 *Then if any man shall say unto you, Lo, here is Christ, or there; believe it not.* At that time if anyone says to you, 'Here is the Christ!' or 'There He is!' do not believe it.
- 24 *For there shall arise false Christs, and false prophets, and shall shew great signs and wonders; insomuch that, if it were possible, they shall deceive the very elect.* False christs and false prophets will appear and perform great signs and wonders — so great as to deceive even the elect, if that were possible.
- 25 *Behold, I have told you before.* I have told You this ahead of time.
- 26 *Wherefore if they shall say unto you, Behold, he is in the desert; go not forth: behold, he is in the secret chambers; believe it not.* So if anyone tells you, 'He is out in the desert,' do not go out. Or, 'He is in the inner rooms,' do not believe it.
- 27 *For as the lightning cometh out of the east, and shineth even unto the west; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.* For as the lightning comes from the east and flashes to the west, so will be the coming of the Son of Man.
- 28 *For wheresoever the carcase is, there will the eagles be gathered together.* Wherever the carcass is, there the vultures will gather.

- 29 *Immediately after the tribulation of those days shall the sun be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light, and the stars shall fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens shall be shaken:* Immediately after the tribulation of those days, the sun will be darkened and the moon will not give its light. The stars will fall from the sky, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken.
- 30 *And then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.* Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in heaven. All the tribes of the earth will mourn. They will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.
- 31 *And he shall send his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they shall gather together his elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.* He will send His angels with a loud trumpet call, and they will gather His elect from the four winds, from one end of the heavens to the other.
- 32 *Now learn a parable of the fig tree; When his branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is nigh:* Now learn this lesson from the fig tree: As soon as its branches become tender and put out leaves, You know that summer is near.
- 33 *So likewise ye, when ye shall see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors.* In the same way, when You see all these things, You know that it is near, right at the door.
- 34 *Verily I say unto you, This generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled.* Truly I tell You, this generation will certainly not pass away until all these things have happened.
- 35 *Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.* Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will never pass away.
- 36 *But of that day and hour knoweth no man, no, not the angels of heaven, but my Father only.* But about that day or hour no one knows — not even the angels in heaven — but My Father only.
- 37 *But as the days of Noe were, so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.* As it was in the days of Noah, so it will be at the coming of the Son of Man.

- 38 *For as in the days that were before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noe entered into the ark,* In the days before the flood, people were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, right up to the day Noah entered the ark.
- 39 *And knew not until the flood came, and took them all away; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.* They knew nothing about what would happen until the flood came and swept them all away. That is how it will be at the coming of the Son of Man.
- 40 *Then shall two be in the field; the one shall be taken, and the other left.* Two men will be in the field — one will be taken and the other left.
- 41 *Two women shall be grinding at the mill; the one shall be taken, and the other left.* Two women will be grinding at the mill — one will be taken and the other left.
- 42 *Watch therefore: for ye know not what hour your Lord doth come.* Therefore keep watch, because You do not know on what day Your Lord will come.
- 43 *But know this, that if the goodman of the house had known in what watch the thief would come, he would have watched, and would not have suffered his house to be broken up.* But understand this: If the owner of the house had known at what time of night the thief was coming, He would have stayed awake and not let His house be broken into.
- 44 *Therefore be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.* So You also must be ready, because the Son of Man will come at an hour when You do not expect Him.
- 45 *Who then is a faithful and wise servant, whom his lord hath made ruler over his household, to give them meat in due season?* Who then is the faithful and wise servant whom the master has put in charge of his household to give them their food at the proper time?
- 46 *Blessed is that servant, whom his lord when he cometh shall find so doing.* It will go well for that servant whose master finds Him doing this when He returns.
- 47 *Verily I say unto you, That he shall make him ruler over all his goods.* Truly I tell You, He will put Him in charge of all His possessions.

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| 48 | <i>But and if that evil servant shall say in his heart, My lord delayeth his coming;</i> | But suppose that servant is wicked and says to Himself, "My master is delayed," |
| 49 | <i>And shall begin to smite his fellowservants, and to eat and drink with the drunken;</i> | and He begins to strike His fellow servants and to eat and drink with drunkards. |
| 50 | <i>The lord of that servant shall come in a day when he looketh not for him, and in an hour that he is not aware of,</i> | The master of that servant will come on a day He does not expect and at an hour He is not aware of. |
| 51 | <i>And shall cut him asunder, and appoint him his portion with the hypocrites: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.</i> | He will cut Him to pieces and assign Him a place with the hypocrites, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. |

Words in this chapter:

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Cross-References:

- v6** — Mark 13:7-8; Luke 21:9; 1 Pet 3:14-15; Isa 8:12-14; John 14:1
v9 — John 16:2; John 15:19-20; Luke 21:16-17; Rev 2:10; Luke 21:12
v13 — Matt 10:22; Mark 13:13; Rev 2:10; Heb 10:39; Heb 3:14
v14 — Rev 14:6; Rom 10:18; Rom 16:25-26; Mark 16:15-16; Luke 24:47
v15 — Dan 9:27; Dan 12:11; Mark 13:14; Luke 21:20; Dan 11:31
v24 — 2 Thess 2:9-11; Mark 13:22; Rev 13:13-14; Matt 24:11; 2 Pet 2:1-3
v29 — Amos 8:9; Joel 3:15; Isa 13:10; Isa 24:23; Mark 13:24-25
v31 — 1 Thess 4:16; Mark 13:27; Isa 27:13; 1 Cor 15:52; Isa 11:12
v34 — Mark 13:30-31; Luke 21:32-33; Matt 16:28; Matt 23:36; Luke 11:50
v35 — Isa 40:8; 1 Pet 1:25; Num 23:19; Isa 55:11; Matt 5:18
v36 — Mark 13:32; Acts 1:7; Matt 24:44; 2 Pet 3:10; 1 Thess 5:2
v42 — Luke 21:36; 1 Thess 5:6; Matt 25:13; Rev 16:15; 1 Cor 16:13

Chapter 25

Jesus tells the parable of the ten virgins, the parable of the talents, and describes the final judgment when the Son of man separates the nations as a shepherd separates sheep from goats.

Those who served the least of His brethren enter eternal life, and those who did not are cast into everlasting punishment.

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| 1 <i>Then shall the kingdom of heaven be likened unto ten virgins, which took their lamps, and went forth to meet the bridegroom.</i> | At that time the kingdom of heaven will be like ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. |
| 2 <i>And five of them were wise, and five were foolish.</i> | Five of them were foolish and five were wise. |
| 3 <i>They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil with them:</i> | The foolish ones took their lamps but did not take any oil with them. |
| 4 <i>But the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps.</i> | The wise ones, however, took oil in jars along with their lamps. |
| 5 <i>While the bridegroom tarried, they all slumbered and slept.</i> | The bridegroom was a long time in coming, and they all grew drowsy and fell asleep. |
| 6 <i>And at midnight there was a cry made, Behold, the bridegroom cometh; go ye out to meet him.</i> | At midnight the cry rang out: "Here is the bridegroom! Come out to meet Him!" |
| 7 <i>Then all those virgins arose, and trimmed their lamps.</i> | Then all the virgins woke up and trimmed their lamps. |
| 8 <i>And the foolish said unto the wise, Give us of your oil; for our lamps are gone out.</i> | The foolish ones said to the wise, "Give us some of Your oil — our lamps are going out." |
| 9 <i>But the wise answered, saying, Not so; lest there be not enough for us and you: but go ye rather to them that sell, and buy for yourselves.</i> | "No," they replied, "there may not be enough for both us and You. Go to those who sell oil and buy some for yourselves." |
| 10 <i>And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came; and they that were ready went in with him to the marriage: and the door was shut.</i> | But while they were on their way to buy the oil, the bridegroom arrived. The ones who were ready went in with Him to the wedding banquet. The door was shut. |

- 11 *Afterward came also the other virgins, saying, Lord, Lord, open to us.* Later the others also came. "Lord! Lord!" they said. "Open the door for us!"
- 12 *But he answered and said, Verily I say unto you, I know you not.* But He replied, "Truly I tell You, I do not know You."
- 13 *Watch therefore, for ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh.* Therefore keep watch, because You do not know the day or the hour.
- 14 *For the kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling into a far country, who called his own servants, and delivered unto them his goods.* It is like a man going on a journey who called his servants and entrusted his wealth to them.
- 15 *And unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one; to every man according to his several ability; and straightway took his journey.* To one He gave five talents, to another two talents, and to another one talent — each according to His ability. Then He went on His journey.
- 16 *Then he that had received the five talents went and traded with the same, and made them other five talents.* The man who had received five talents went at once and put his money to work and gained five more.
- 17 *And likewise he that had received two, he also gained other two.* In the same way, the one with two talents gained two more.
- 18 *But he that had received one went and digged in the earth, and hid his lord's money.* But the man who had received one talent went off, dug a hole in the ground, and hid his master's money.
- 19 *After a long time the lord of those servants cometh, and reckoneth with them.* After a long time the master of those servants returned and settled accounts with them.
- 20 *And so he that had received five talents came and brought other five talents, saying, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me five talents: behold, I have gained beside them five talents more.* The man who had received five talents came and brought the other five. "Master," he said, "you entrusted me with five talents. See, I have gained five more."

- 21 *His lord said unto him, Well done, thou good and faithful servant: thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.* His master replied, "Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things. Come and share your master's happiness!"
- 22 *He also that had received two talents came and said, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me two talents: behold, I have gained two other talents beside them.* The man with two talents also came. "Master," he said, "you entrusted me with two talents. See, I have gained two more."
- 23 *His lord said unto him, Well done, good and faithful servant; thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.* His master replied, "Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things. Come and share your master's happiness!"
- 24 *Then he which had received the one talent came and said, Lord, I knew thee that thou art an hard man, reaping where thou hast not sown, and gathering where thou hast not strawed:* Then the man who had received one talent came. "Master," he said, "I knew that you are a hard man, harvesting where you have not sown and gathering where you have not scattered seed.
- 25 *And I was afraid, and went and hid thy talent in the earth: lo, there thou hast that is thine.* So I was afraid and went out and hid your talent in the ground. Here is what belongs to you."
- 26 *His lord answered and said unto him, Thou wicked and slothful servant, thou knewest that I reap where I sowed not, and gather where I have not strawed:* His master replied, "You wicked and lazy servant! So you knew that I harvest where I have not sown and gather where I have not scattered seed?
- 27 *Thou oughtest therefore to have put my money to the exchangers, and then at my coming I should have received mine own with usury.* Then you should have put my money on deposit with the bankers, so that when I returned I would have received it back with interest.

- 28 *Take therefore the talent from him, and give it unto him which hath ten talents.* Take the talent from him and give it to the one who has ten talents.
- 29 *For unto every one that hath shall be given, and he shall have abundance: but from him that hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath.* For everyone who has will be given more, and he will have an abundance. But from the one who does not have, even what he has will be taken away.
- 30 *And cast ye the unprofitable servant into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.* And throw that worthless servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."
- 31 *When the Son of man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory:* When the Son of Man comes in His glory, and all the holy angels with Him, He will sit on His glorious throne.
- 32 *And before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats:* All the nations will be gathered before him, and he will separate the people from one another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats.
- 33 *And he shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left.* He will put the sheep on His right and the goats on His left.
- 34 *Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world:* Then the King will say to those on his right, "Come, you who are blessed by My Father. Inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world.
- 35 *For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in:* For I was hungry and you gave Me food. I was thirsty and you gave Me drink. I was a stranger and you took Me in.
- 36 *Naked, and ye clothed me: I was sick, and ye visited me: I was in prison, and ye came unto me.* I was naked and you clothed Me. I was sick and you looked after Me. I was in prison and you came to visit Me."

- 37 *Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink?* Then the righteous will answer him, "Lord, when did we see You hungry and feed You, or thirsty and give You something to drink?"
- 38 *When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee?* When did we see You a stranger and take You in, or naked and clothe You?
- 39 *Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee?* When did we see You sick or in prison and go to visit You?"
- 40 *And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.* The King will reply, "Truly I tell you, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers of Mine, you did for Me."
- 41 *Then shall he say also unto them on the left hand, Depart from me, ye cursed, into everlasting fire, prepared for the devil and his angels:* Then He will say to those on His left, "Depart from Me, you who are cursed, into the everlasting fire prepared for the devil and his angels."
- 42 *For I was an hungred, and ye gave me no meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me no drink:* For I was hungry and you gave Me nothing to eat. I was thirsty and you gave Me nothing to drink.
- 43 *I was a stranger, and ye took me not in: naked, and ye clothed me not: sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not.* I was a stranger and you did not take Me in. I was naked and you did not clothe Me. I was sick and in prison and you did not visit Me."
- 44 *Then shall they also answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, or athirst, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and did not minister unto thee?* They also will answer, "Lord, when did we see You hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not help You?"
- 45 *Then shall he answer them, saying, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye did it not to one of the least of these, ye did it not to me.* He will reply, "Truly I tell you, whatever you did not do for one of the least of these, you did not do for Me."

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| 46 <i>And these shall go away into everlasting punishment: but the righteous into life eternal.</i> | Then they will go away to eternal punishment, but the righteous to eternal life." |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 12:35-36; Matt 24:42-51; Rev 19:7; Phil 2:15-16; Rev 21:9
- v13 — Matt 24:42-44; Rev 16:15; 1 Thess 5:6; Luke 21:36; 1 Cor 16:13
- v14 — Mark 13:34; Luke 19:12-27; 1 Pet 4:9-11; Rom 12:6-8; Matt 25:14-30
- v21 — Matt 25:23; Luke 16:10; John 12:26; 2 Tim 2:12; Rev 3:21
- v29 — Luke 8:18; Matt 13:12; Mark 4:25; Luke 19:25-26; John 15:2
- v31 — Rev 1:7; 2 Thess 1:7-8; Matt 19:28; Mark 8:38; Jude 1:14
- v32 — Mal 3:18; Matt 13:49; 2 Cor 5:10; Ps 98:9; Ezek 34:17-22
- v34 — 1 Pet 1:19-20; Jas 2:5; Rev 21:7; Rev 13:8; Luke 12:32
- v35 — 1 John 3:16-19; Jas 2:15-16; Deut 15:7-11; Heb 13:16; Ezek 18:16
- v40 — Prov 19:17; Prov 14:31; Matt 10:42; Mark 9:41; 1 Pet 1:22
- v45 — Prov 21:13; Prov 17:5; Prov 14:31; Matt 25:40; Acts 9:5
- v46 — Dan 12:2; John 5:29; John 3:36; Rev 21:8; Rev 20:15

Chapter 26

Jesus observes the Last Supper with His disciples, institutes the new covenant in His blood, and prays in agony in the Garden of Gethsemane. Judas betrays Him with a kiss, and Jesus is arrested, tried before Caiaphas and the Sanhedrin, and denied three times by Peter.

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| 1 <i>And it came to pass, when Jesus had finished all these sayings, he said unto his disciples,</i> | When Jesus had finished all these teachings, He said to His disciples, |
| 2 <i>Ye know that after two days is the feast of the passover, and the Son of man is betrayed to be crucified.</i> | "As You know, the Passover is two days away, and the Son of Man will be handed over to be crucified." |
| 3 <i>Then assembled together the chief priests, and the scribes, and the elders of the people, unto the palace of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas,</i> | Then the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders of the people gathered at the palace of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas. |

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| 4 <i>And consulted that they might take Jesus by subtilty, and kill him.</i> | They made plans to arrest Jesus secretly and kill Him. |
| 5 <i>But they said, Not on the feast day, lest there be an uproar among the people.</i> | "But not during the feast," they said, "or there may be a riot among the people." |
| 6 <i>Now when Jesus was in Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper,</i> | While Jesus was in Bethany at the house of Simon the leper, |
| 7 <i>There came unto him a woman having an alabaster box of very precious ointment, and poured it on his head, as he sat at meat.</i> | a woman came to him with an alabaster jar of very expensive perfume and poured it on His head as He was reclining at the table. |
| 8 <i>But when his disciples saw it, they had indignation, saying, To what purpose is this waste?</i> | When the disciples saw this, they were indignant. "Why this waste?" they asked. |
| 9 <i>For this ointment might have been sold for much, and given to the poor.</i> | "This could have been sold for a great deal of money and given to the poor." |
| 10 <i>When Jesus understood it, he said unto them, Why trouble ye the woman? for she hath wrought a good work upon me.</i> | Aware of their reaction, Jesus said to them, "Why are You bothering this woman? She has done a beautiful thing for Me. |
| 11 <i>For ye have the poor always with you; but me ye have not always.</i> | The poor You will always have with You, but You will not always have Me. |
| 12 <i>For in that she hath poured this ointment on my body, she did it for my burial.</i> | When she poured this perfume on My body, she did it to prepare Me for burial. |
| 13 <i>Verily I say unto you, Whosoever this gospel shall be preached in the whole world, there shall also this, that this woman hath done, be told for a memorial of her.</i> | Truly I tell You, wherever this gospel is preached throughout the world, what she has done will also be told, in memory of her." |
| 14 <i>Then one of the twelve, called Judas Iscariot, went unto the chief priests,</i> | Then one of the twelve — the one called Judas Iscariot — went to the chief priests |

- 15 *And said unto them, What will ye give me, and I will deliver him unto you? And they covenanted with him for thirty pieces of silver.* and asked, "What are you willing to give me if I hand Him over to you?" They counted out thirty silver coins for him.
- 16 *And from that time he sought opportunity to betray him.* From that time on Judas watched for an opportunity to hand him over.
- 17 *Now the first day of the feast of unleavened bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare for thee to eat the passover?* On the first day of the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the disciples came to Jesus and asked, "Where do You want us to prepare for You to eat the Passover?"
- 18 *And he said, Go into the city to such a man, and say unto him, The Master saith, My time is at hand; I will keep the passover at thy house with my disciples.* He replied, "Go into the city to a certain man and tell Him, 'The Master says: My time is near. I am going to celebrate the Passover with My disciples at Your house.'"
- 19 *And the disciples did as Jesus had appointed them; and they made ready the passover.* So the disciples did as Jesus had directed them and prepared the Passover.
- 20 *Now when the even was come, he sat down with the twelve.* When evening came, Jesus was reclining at the table with the twelve.
- 21 *And as they did eat, he said, Verily I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.* While they were eating, He said, "Truly I tell You, one of You will betray Me."
- 22 *And they were exceeding sorrowful, and began every one of them to say unto him, Lord, is it I?* They were deeply grieved and began to say to Him one after another, "Surely not I, Lord?"
- 23 *And he answered and said, He that dippeth his hand with me in the dish, the same shall betray me.* He answered, "The one who has dipped his hand into the bowl with Me will betray Me."

- 24 *The Son of man goeth as it is written of him: but woe unto that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! it had been good for that man if he had not been born.* The Son of Man will go just as it is written about Him. But woe to that man who betrays the Son of Man! It would be better for Him if He had not been born."
- 25 *Then Judas, which betrayed him, answered and said, Master, is it I? He said unto him, Thou hast said.* Then Judas, the one who would betray him, said, "Surely not I, Master?" Jesus answered, "You have said it."
- 26 *And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body.* While they were eating, Jesus took bread, gave thanks, broke it, and gave it to His disciples. He said, "Take and eat; this is My body."
- 27 *And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it;* Then He took a cup, gave thanks, and offered it to them, saying, "Drink from it, all of You.
- 28 *For this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.* This is My blood of the new testament, which is poured out for many for the remission of sins.
- 29 *But I say unto you, I will not drink henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.* I tell You, I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with You in My Father's kingdom."
- 30 *And when they had sung an hymn, they went out into the mount of Olives.* When they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.
- 31 *Then saith Jesus unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered abroad.* Then Jesus told them, "This very night You will all fall away because of Me. For it is written: 'I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.'
- 32 *But after I am risen again, I will go before you into Galilee.* But after I am raised, I will go ahead of You into Galilee."

- 33 *Peter answered and said unto him, Though all men shall be offended because of thee, yet will I never be offended.* Peter declared, "Even if all the others fall away because of You, I never will."
- 34 *Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, That this night, before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.* Jesus answered, "Truly I tell You, this very night, before the rooster crows, You will deny Me three times."
- 35 *Peter said unto him, Though I should die with thee, yet will I not deny thee. Likewise also said all the disciples.* Peter said, "Even if I have to die with you, I will never deny You." And all the other disciples said the same.
- 36 *Then cometh Jesus with them unto a place called Gethsemane, and saith unto the disciples, Sit ye here, while I go and pray yonder.* Then Jesus went with His disciples to a place called Gethsemane, and He said to them, "Sit here while I go over there and pray."
- 37 *And he took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be sorrowful and very heavy.* He took Peter and the two sons of Zebedee along with him and began to be sorrowful and deeply troubled.
- 38 *Then saith he unto them, My soul is exceeding sorrowful, even unto death: tarry ye here, and watch with me.* He said to them, "My soul is overwhelmed with sorrow to the point of death. Stay here and keep watch with Me."
- 39 *And he went a little further, and fell on his face, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if it be possible, let this cup pass from me: nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt.* Going a little farther, He fell face down and prayed, "My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me. Yet not as I will, but as You will."
- 40 *And he cometh unto the disciples, and findeth them asleep, and saith unto Peter, What, could ye not watch with me one hour?* Then he returned to his disciples and found them sleeping. He said to Peter, "Could you not keep watch with Me for one hour?"
- 41 *Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.* Watch and pray so that you will not fall into temptation. The spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak."

- 42 *He went away again the second time, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if this cup may not pass away from me, except I drink it, thy will be done.* He went away a second time and prayed, "My Father, if this cup cannot pass away unless I drink it, Your will be done."
- 43 *And he came and found them asleep again: for their eyes were heavy.* When He came back, He again found them sleeping, because their eyes were heavy.
- 44 *And he left them, and went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words.* So He left them and went away once more and prayed the third time, saying the same thing.
- 45 *Then cometh he to his disciples, and saith unto them, Sleep on now, and take your rest: behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.* Then He returned to the disciples and said to them, "Are You still sleeping and resting? The hour has come. The Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners.
- 46 *Rise, let us be going: behold, he is at hand that doth betray me.* Rise! Let us go! My betrayer is approaching."
- 47 *And while he yet spake, lo, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and elders of the people.* While He was still speaking, Judas — one of the twelve — arrived. With him was a large crowd armed with swords and clubs, sent from the chief priests and elders of the people.
- 48 *Now he that betrayed him gave them a sign, saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he: hold him fast.* Now the betrayer had arranged a sign with them: "The one I kiss is the man; arrest him."
- 49 *And forthwith he came to Jesus, and said, Hail, master; and kissed him.* Going at once to Jesus, Judas said, "Greetings, Master!" and kissed him.
- 50 *And Jesus said unto him, Friend, wherefore art thou come? Then came they, and laid hands on Jesus, and took him.* Jesus replied, "Friend, why have You come?" Then the men stepped forward, seized Jesus, and arrested Him.

- 51 *And, behold, one of them which were with Jesus stretched out his hand, and drew his sword, and struck a servant of the high priest's, and smote off his ear.* Then one of Jesus' companions reached out His hand, drew his sword, and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear.
- 52 *Then said Jesus unto him, Put up again thy sword into his place: for all they that take the sword shall perish with the sword.* "Put Your sword back in its place," Jesus said. "For all who draw the sword will die by the sword.
- 53 *Thinkest thou that I cannot now pray to my Father, and he shall presently give me more than twelve legions of angels?* Do You think I cannot call on My Father, and He will at once put at My disposal more than twelve legions of angels?
- 54 *But how then shall the scriptures be fulfilled, that thus it must be?* But how then would the Scriptures be fulfilled that say it must happen this way?"
- 55 *In that same hour said Jesus to the multitudes, Are ye come out as against a thief with swords and staves for to take me? I sat daily with you teaching in the temple, and ye laid no hold on me.* At that hour Jesus said to the crowd, "Have You come out with swords and clubs to arrest Me as though I were a criminal? Every day I sat in the temple teaching, and You did not arrest Me.
- 56 *But all this was done, that the scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled. Then all the disciples forsook him, and fled.* But all this has taken place that the writings of the prophets might be fulfilled." Then all the disciples deserted Him and fled.
- 57 *And they that had laid hold on Jesus led him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were assembled.* Those who had arrested Jesus led Him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders had assembled.
- 58 *But Peter followed him afar off unto the high priest's palace, and went in, and sat with the servants, to see the end.* But Peter followed him at a distance, right up to the courtyard of the high priest. He went in and sat with the guards to see how things would turn out.

- 59 *Now the chief priests, and elders, and all the council, sought false witness against Jesus, to put him to death;* The chief priests and the whole council looked for false testimony against Jesus so they could put Him to death.
- 60 *But found none: yea, though many false witnesses came, yet found they none. At the last came two false witnesses,* But they found none, even though many false witnesses came forward. Finally two came forward
- 61 *And said, This fellow said, I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.* and said, "This fellow declared, 'I am able to destroy the temple of God and rebuild it in three days.'"
- 62 *And the high priest arose, and said unto him, Answerest thou nothing? what is it which these witness against thee?* Then the high priest stood up and said to Him, "Are You not going to answer? What is this testimony these men are bringing against You?"
- 63 *But Jesus held his peace. And the high priest answered and said unto him, I adjure thee by the living God, that thou tell us whether thou be the Christ, the Son of God.* But Jesus was silent. The high priest said to Him, "I charge You under oath by the living God: Tell us if You are the Christ, the Son of God."
- 64 *Jesus saith unto him, Thou hast said: nevertheless I say unto you, Hereafter shall ye see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.* Jesus said to Him, "You have said it. But I tell You: From now on You will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power and coming on the clouds of heaven."
- 65 *Then the high priest rent his clothes, saying, He hath spoken blasphemy; what further need have we of witnesses? behold, now ye have heard his blasphemy.* Then the high priest tore His clothes and said, "He has spoken blasphemy! Why do we need any more witnesses? Look — now You have heard the blasphemy.
- 66 *What think ye? They answered and said, He is guilty of death.* What do You think?" "He deserves death," they answered.
- 67 *Then did they spit in his face, and buffeted him; and others smote him with the palms of their hands,* Then they spit in His face and struck Him with their fists. Others slapped Him

- 68 *Saying, Prophecy unto us, thou Christ, Who is he that smote thee?* and said, "Prophecy to us, Christ! Who hit You?"
- 69 *Now Peter sat without in the palace: and a damsel came unto him, saying, Thou also wast with Jesus of Galilee.* Now Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard. A servant girl came to Him and said, "You also were with Jesus of Galilee."
- 70 *But he denied before them all, saying, I know not what thou sayest.* But He denied it before them all. "I don't know what You are talking about," he said.
- 71 *And when he was gone out into the porch, another maid saw him, and said unto them that were there, This fellow was also with Jesus of Nazareth.* Then He went out to the gateway, where another servant girl saw Him and said to the people there, "This fellow was with Jesus of Nazareth."
- 72 *And again he denied with an oath, I do not know the man.* He denied it again, with an oath: "I do not know the man!"
- 73 *And after a while came unto him they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art one of them; for thy speech bewrayeth thee.* After a little while, those standing there came up to Peter and said, "Surely you are one of them — your accent gives you away."
- 74 *Then began he to curse and to swear, saying, I know not the man. And immediately the cock crew.* Then he began to call down curses, and he swore to them, "I do not know the man!" Immediately a rooster crowed.
- 75 *And Peter remembered the word of Jesus, which said unto him, Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice. And he went out, and wept bitterly.* Then Peter remembered the words Jesus had spoken: "Before the rooster crows, You will deny Me three times." He went outside and wept bitterly.

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Caiaphas (*KY-ah-fas*) — The Jewish high priest during Jesus's trial — he declared it better for one man to die for the nation; he unwittingly prophesied Christ's death for all people.

Gethsemane (*geth-SEM-ah-nee*) — A garden at the foot of the Mount of Olives — the place where Jesus prayed the night of His betrayal; his name means 'olive press.'

Cross-References:

- v6 — Mark 14:3-9; John 12:1-8; Luke 7:37-39; John 11:1-2; Matt 21:17
- v11 — Deut 15:11; Mark 14:7; John 12:8; John 16:28; John 16:5
- v26 — 1 Cor 11:23-29; Luke 22:18-20; 1 Cor 10:16-17; John 6:33-35; 1 Cor 10:4
- v28 — Heb 10:4-14; Heb 9:14-22; Lev 17:11; Matt 20:28; Ex 24:7-8
- v29 — Heb 12:2; Rev 7:17; Mark 14:25; Luke 22:15-18; Ps 40:3
- v31 — Zech 13:7; Mark 14:27-28; John 16:32; Ezek 34:5-6; Ps 69:20
- v39 — John 6:38; Phil 2:8; Luke 22:41-42; Matt 26:42; John 5:30
- v41 — Luke 22:46; Mark 14:38; Eph 6:18; Matt 6:13; Gal 5:16-17
- v52 — Rev 13:10; Gen 9:6; Rom 12:19; 1 Pet 2:21-23; Rev 16:6
- v53 — 2 Kgs 6:17; Matt 4:11; Dan 7:10; Luke 8:30; Matt 25:31
- v56 — Zech 13:7; John 16:32; Mark 14:50-52; Matt 26:31; Matt 26:54
- v64 — Dan 7:13; Mark 14:62; Ps 110:1; Heb 1:3; Rev 1:7

Chapter 27

Judas, filled with remorse, returns the thirty pieces of silver and hangs himself. Jesus is tried before Pontius Pilate, scourged, mocked by the soldiers, and crucified at Golgotha. He cries out to God, gives up His spirit, and is buried in the tomb of Joseph of Arimathaea.

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| 1 | <i>When the morning was come, all the chief priests and elders of the people took counsel against Jesus to put him to death:</i> | Early in the morning, all the chief priests and elders of the people made a plan to have Jesus put to death. |
| 2 | <i>And when they had bound him, they led him away, and delivered him to Pontius Pilate the governor.</i> | They bound Him, led Him away, and handed Him over to Pontius Pilate, the governor. |
| 3 | <i>Then Judas, which had betrayed him, when he saw that he was condemned, repented himself, and brought again the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and elders,</i> | When Judas, who had betrayed him, saw that Jesus was condemned, He was filled with remorse and returned the thirty silver coins to the chief priests and elders. |
| 4 | <i>Saying, I have sinned in that I have betrayed the innocent blood. And they said, What is that to us? see thou to that.</i> | "I have sinned," he said, "for I have betrayed innocent blood." "What is that to us?" they replied. "That is Your responsibility." |
| 5 | <i>And he cast down the pieces of silver in the temple, and departed, and went and hanged himself.</i> | So Judas threw the money into the temple and left. Then he went away and hanged himself. |

- 6 *And the chief priests took the silver pieces, and said, It is not lawful for to put them into the treasury, because it is the price of blood.* The chief priests picked up the coins and said, "It is against the law to put this into the treasury, since it is blood money."
- 7 *And they took counsel, and bought with them the potter's field, to bury strangers in.* So they decided to use the money to buy the potter's field as a burial place for foreigners.
- 8 *Wherefore that field was called, The field of blood, unto this day.* That is why it has been called the Field of Blood to this day.
- 9 *Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying, And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of him that was valued, whom they of the children of Israel did value;* Then what was spoken by Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled: "They took the thirty silver coins, the price set on Him by the people of Israel,
- 10 *And gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord appointed me.* and they used them to buy the potter's field, as the Lord directed me."
- 11 *And Jesus stood before the governor: and the governor asked him, saying, Art thou the King of the Jews? And Jesus said unto him, Thou sayest.* Meanwhile Jesus stood before the governor, and the governor asked Him, "Are You the king of the Jews?" "You have said so," Jesus replied.
- 12 *And when he was accused of the chief priests and elders, he answered nothing.* When He was accused by the chief priests and elders, He gave no answer.
- 13 *Then said Pilate unto him, Hearest thou not how many things they witness against thee?* Then Pilate asked him, "Don't you hear the testimony they are bringing against You?"
- 14 *And he answered him to never a word; insomuch that the governor marvelled greatly.* But Jesus made no reply, not even to a single charge — to the great amazement of the governor.
- 15 *Now at that feast the governor was wont to release unto the people a prisoner, whom they would.* Now it was the governor's custom at the feast to release a prisoner chosen by the crowd.

- 16 *And they had then a notable prisoner, called Barabbas.* At that time they had a notable prisoner called Barabbas.
- 17 *Therefore when they were gathered together, Pilate said unto them, Whom will ye that I release unto you? Barabbas, or Jesus which is called Christ?* So when the crowd had gathered, Pilate asked them, "Which one do you want me to release to You: Barabbas, or Jesus Who is called Christ?"
- 18 *For he knew that for envy they had delivered him.* For He knew it was out of envy that they had handed Jesus over to Him.
- 19 *When he was set down on the judgment seat, his wife sent unto him, saying, Have thou nothing to do with that just man: for I have suffered many things this day in a dream because of him.* While Pilate was sitting on the judge's seat, his wife sent him a message: "Don't have anything to do with that innocent man, for I have suffered a great deal today in a dream because of Him."
- 20 *But the chief priests and elders persuaded the multitude that they should ask Barabbas, and destroy Jesus.* But the chief priests and the elders persuaded the crowd to ask for Barabbas and to have Jesus executed.
- 21 *The governor answered and said unto them, Whether of the twain will ye that I release unto you? They said, Barabbas.* "Which of the two do You want me to release to You?" asked the governor. "Barabbas," they answered.
- 22 *Pilate saith unto them, What shall I do then with Jesus which is called Christ? They all say unto him, Let him be crucified.* "What shall I do, then, with Jesus Who is called Christ?" Pilate asked. They all answered, "Crucify him!"
- 23 *And the governor said, Why, what evil hath he done? But they cried out the more, saying, Let him be crucified.* "Why? What crime has He committed?" asked Pilate. But they shouted all the louder, "Crucify him!"

- 24 *When Pilate saw that he could prevail nothing, but that rather a tumult was made, he took water, and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, I am innocent of the blood of this just person: see ye to it.* When Pilate saw that he was getting nowhere, but that a riot was starting, he took water and washed his hands in front of the crowd. "I am innocent of this man's blood," he said. "It is your responsibility!"
- 25 *Then answered all the people, and said, His blood be on us, and on our children.* All the people answered, "His blood is on us and on our children!"
- 26 *Then released he Barabbas unto them: and when he had scourged Jesus, he delivered him to be crucified.* Then He released Barabbas to them. But He had Jesus flogged and handed Him over to be crucified.
- 27 *Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the common hall, and gathered unto him the whole band of soldiers.* Then the governor's soldiers took Jesus into the Praetorium and gathered the whole company of soldiers around Him.
- 28 *And they stripped him, and put on him a scarlet robe.* They stripped Him and put a scarlet robe on Him.
- 29 *And when they had platted a crown of thorns, they put it upon his head, and a reed in his right hand: and they bowed the knee before him, and mocked him, saying, Hail, King of the Jews!* They twisted together a crown of thorns and set it on His head. They put a staff in His right hand. Then they knelt in front of Him and mocked Him. "Hail, king of the Jews!" they said.
- 30 *And they spit upon him, and took the reed, and smote him on the head.* They spit on Him and took the staff and struck Him on the head again and again.
- 31 *And after that they had mocked him, they took the robe off from him, and put his own raiment on him, and led him away to crucify him.* After they had mocked Him, they took off the robe and put His own clothes back on Him. Then they led Him away to crucify Him.

- 32 *And as they came out, they found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name: him they compelled to bear his cross.* As they were going out, they met a man from Cyrene named Simon, and they forced him to carry the cross.
- 33 *And when they were come unto a place called Golgotha, that is to say, a place of a skull,* They came to a place called Golgotha (which means "the place of the skull").
- 34 *They gave him vinegar to drink mingled with gall: and when he had tasted thereof, he would not drink.* There they offered Jesus wine mixed with gall to drink, but after tasting it, He refused to drink it.
- 35 *And they crucified him, and parted his garments, casting lots: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, They parted my garments among them, and upon my vesture did they cast lots.* When they had crucified Him, they divided up His clothes by casting lots, to fulfill what the prophet said: "They divided My garments among them and cast lots for My clothing."
- 36 *And sitting down they watched him there;* And sitting down they kept watch over Him there.
- 37 *And set up over his head his accusation written, THIS IS JESUS THE KING OF THE JEWS.* Above His head they placed the written charge against Him: THIS IS JESUS, THE KING OF THE JEWS.
- 38 *Then were there two thieves crucified with him, one on the right hand, and another on the left.* Two criminals were crucified with Him, one on His right and one on His left.
- 39 *And they that passed by reviled him, wagging their heads,* Those who passed by hurled insults at Him, shaking their heads
- 40 *And saying, Thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days, save thyself. If thou be the Son of God, come down from the cross.* and saying, "You who are going to destroy the temple and build it in three days — save Yourself! If You are the Son of God, come down from the cross!"
- 41 *Likewise also the chief priests mocking him, with the scribes and elders, said,* In the same way the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders mocked Him.

- 42 *He saved others; himself he cannot save. If he be the King of Israel, let him now come down from the cross, and we will believe him.* "He saved others," they said, "but He can't save Himself! He's the King of Israel! Let him come down now from the cross, and we will believe in Him.
- 43 *He trusted in God; let him deliver him now, if he will have him: for he said, I am the Son of God.* He trusts in God. Let God rescue Him now if He wants Him — for He said, 'I am the Son of God.'"
- 44 *The thieves also, which were crucified with him, cast the same in his teeth.* In the same way the criminals who were crucified with Him also hurled insults at Him.
- 45 *Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour.* From the sixth hour until the ninth hour, darkness came over all the land.
- 46 *And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? that is to say, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?* About the ninth hour Jesus cried out in a loud voice, "Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani?" — which means, "My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?"
- 47 *Some of them that stood there, when they heard that, said, This man calleth for Elias.* When some of those standing there heard this, they said, "He's calling Elijah."
- 48 *And straightway one of them ran, and took a sponge, and filled it with vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave him to drink.* Immediately one of them ran and got a sponge. He filled it with wine vinegar, put it on a staff, and offered it to Jesus to drink.
- 49 *The rest said, Let be, let us see whether Elias will come to save him.* The rest said, "Leave Him alone. Let's see if Elijah comes to save him."
- 50 *Jesus, when he had cried again with a loud voice, yielded up the ghost.* And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, He gave up His spirit.
- 51 *And, behold, the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent;* At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. The earth shook, and the rocks split.

- 52 *And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose,* The tombs broke open and many bodies of holy people who had died were raised to life.
- 53 *And came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.* They came out of the tombs after Jesus' resurrection and went into the holy city and appeared to many people.
- 54 *Now when the centurion, and they that were with him, watching Jesus, saw the earthquake, and those things that were done, they feared greatly, saying, Truly this was the Son of God.* When the centurion and those with him who were guarding Jesus saw the earthquake and all that had happened, they were terrified and said, "Surely He was the Son of God!"
- 55 *And many women were there beholding afar off, which followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering unto him:* Many women were there, watching from a distance. They had followed Jesus from Galilee to care for His needs.
- 56 *Among which was Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James and Josés, and the mother of Zebedee's children.* Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Josés, and the mother of Zebedee's sons.
- 57 *When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple:* As evening approached, a rich man from Arimathea named Joseph, who had himself become a disciple of Jesus, came.
- 58 *He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered.* Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body, and Pilate ordered that it be given to him.
- 59 *And when Joseph had taken the body, he wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,* Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,
- 60 *And laid it in his own new tomb, which he had hewn out in the rock: and he rolled a great stone to the door of the sepulchre, and departed.* and placed it in his own new tomb that he had cut out of the rock. He rolled a large stone in front of the entrance to the tomb and went away.

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| <p>61 <i>And there was Mary Magdalene, and the other Mary, sitting over against the sepulchre.</i></p> <p>62 <i>Now the next day, that followed the day of the preparation, the chief priests and Pharisees came together unto Pilate,</i></p> <p>63 <i>Saying, Sir, we remember that that deceiver said, while he was yet alive, After three days I will rise again.</i></p> <p>64 <i>Command therefore that the sepulchre be made sure until the third day, lest his disciples come by night, and steal him away, and say unto the people, He is risen from the dead: so the last error shall be worse than the first.</i></p> <p>65 <i>Pilate said unto them, Ye have a watch: go your way, make it as sure as ye can.</i></p> <p>66 <i>So they went, and made the sepulchre sure, sealing the stone, and setting a watch.</i></p> | <p>Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were sitting there opposite the tomb.</p> <p>The next day, the one after Preparation Day, the chief priests and the Pharisees gathered before Pilate.</p> <p>"Sir," they said, "we remember that while He was still alive that deceiver said, 'After three days I will rise again.'</p> <p>So give the order for the tomb to be made secure until the third day. Otherwise, His disciples may come and steal the body and tell the people that he has been raised from the dead. This last deception will be worse than the first."</p> <p>"Take a guard," Pilate answered. "Go, make the tomb as secure as you know how."</p> <p>So they went and made the tomb secure by putting a seal on the stone and setting the guard.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani (*EL-ee EL-ee LAH-mah sah-BAK-thah-nee*) — Jesus's cry from the cross — Aramaic for 'My God, my God, why have You forsaken me?' (Psalm 22:1).

Eli (*EE-ly*) — The high priest who raised Samuel — his sons Hophni and Phinehas were corrupt; he died when he heard the ark was captured; his name means 'my God.'

Pilate (*PY-lat*) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Golgotha (*GOL-gah-thah*) — The hill outside Jerusalem where Jesus was crucified — an Aramaic word meaning 'place of the skull'; called Calvary in Latin.

Cross-References:

v9 — Zech 11:12-13

v25 — Josh 2:19; Acts 5:28; Acts 7:52; Deut 19:10; 1 Thess 2:15-16
 v26 — Isa 53:5; John 19:1; Mark 15:15; Luke 23:16; Isa 50:6
 v32 — Mark 15:21; Luke 23:26; Matt 16:24; Acts 2:10; Acts 6:9
 v34 — Ps 69:21; Mark 15:23; Matt 27:48; John 19:28-30
 v35 — Ps 22:18; Mark 15:24-32; Luke 23:34; John 19:23-24; Acts 4:10
 v38 — John 19:18; Luke 23:39-43; John 19:31-35; Mark 15:27; Isa 53:12
 v45 — Amos 8:9; Mark 15:33-34; Isa 50:3; Luke 23:44-45; Rev 9:2
 v46 — Ps 22:1; Heb 5:7; Isa 53:10; Mark 15:34; John 19:28-30
 v50 — John 19:30; Isa 53:9-12; Ps 22:14-15; Luke 23:46; Heb 9:14
 v51 — Heb 10:19-22; Mark 15:38; Heb 6:19; Luke 23:45; Rev 11:19
 v52 — Isa 26:19; 1 Thess 4:14; John 5:25-29; 1 Cor 15:20; Dan 12:2

Chapter 28

An angel rolls away the stone from the tomb and announces to Mary Magdalene and the other Mary that Jesus has risen from the dead. The risen Jesus appears to the women and later to the eleven disciples in Galilee, where He commissions them to go and make disciples of all nations.

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| 1 | <i>In the end of the sabbath, as it began to dawn toward the first day of the week, came Mary Magdalene and the other Mary to see the sepulchre.</i> | After the Sabbath, at dawn on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb. |
| 2 | <i>And, behold, there was a great earthquake: for the angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and came and rolled back the stone from the door, and sat upon it.</i> | There was a great earthquake. An angel of the Lord came down from heaven, rolled back the stone, and sat on it. |
| 3 | <i>His countenance was like lightning, and his raiment white as snow:</i> | His face was like lightning, and his clothes were white as snow. |
| 4 | <i>And for fear of him the keepers did shake, and became as dead men.</i> | The guards were so afraid of him that they shook and became like dead men. |
| 5 | <i>And the angel answered and said unto the women, Fear not ye: for I know that ye seek Jesus, which was crucified.</i> | The angel said to the women, "Do not be afraid, for I know that You are looking for Jesus, Who was crucified. |
| 6 | <i>He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.</i> | He is not here; He has risen, just as He said. Come and see the place where He lay. |

- 7 *And go quickly, and tell his disciples that he is risen from the dead; and, behold, he goeth before you into Galilee; there shall ye see him: lo, I have told you.* Then go quickly and tell His disciples: 'He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of You into Galilee. There You will see Him.' Now I have told You."
- 8 *And they departed quickly from the sepulchre with fear and great joy; and did run to bring his disciples word.* So the women hurried away from the tomb, afraid yet filled with joy, and ran to tell His disciples.
- 9 *And as they went to tell his disciples, behold, Jesus met them, saying, All hail. And they came and held him by the feet, and worshipped him.* Suddenly Jesus met them. "Greetings," He said. They came to Him, clasped His feet, and worshiped Him.
- 10 *Then said Jesus unto them, Be not afraid: go tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, and there shall they see me.* Then Jesus said to them, "Do not be afraid. Go and tell My brothers to go to Galilee. There they will see Me."
- 11 *Now when they were going, behold, some of the watch came into the city, and shewed unto the chief priests all the things that were done.* While the women were on their way, some of the guards went into the city and reported to the chief priests everything that had happened.
- 12 *And when they were assembled with the elders, and had taken counsel, they gave large money unto the soldiers,* When the chief priests met with the elders and made a plan, they gave the soldiers a large sum of money
- 13 *Saying, Say ye, His disciples came by night, and stole him away while we slept.* and told them, "You are to say, 'His disciples came during the night and stole Him away while we were asleep.'
- 14 *And if this come to the governor's ears, we will persuade him, and secure you.* If this report reaches the governor, we will satisfy Him and keep You out of trouble."
- 15 *So they took the money, and did as they were taught: and this saying is commonly reported among the Jews until this day.* So the soldiers took the money and did as they were instructed. And this story has been widely spread among the Jews to this day.

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| <p>16 <i>Then the eleven disciples went away into Galilee, into a mountain where Jesus had appointed them.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And when they saw him, they worshipped him: but some doubted.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And Jesus came and spake unto them, saying, All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost:</i></p> <p>20 <i>Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.</i></p> | <p>Then the eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus had told them to go.</p> <p>When they saw Him, they worshiped Him; but some doubted.</p> <p>Then Jesus came to them and said, "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to Me.</p> <p>Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost,</p> <p>teaching them to obey everything I have commanded You. And surely I am with You always, to the very end of the world."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mark 16:1-8; John 20:1-10; Matt 27:56; Luke 23:56-24:10; Luke 24:22
- v2 — John 20:12-13; Luke 24:2-5; Mark 16:3-5; Acts 16:26
- v3 — Mark 9:3; Acts 1:10; Mark 16:5
- v6 — Mark 16:6; Matt 12:40; Luke 24:6-8; Matt 16:21; Luke 24:23
- v7 — Matt 26:32; Luke 24:22-24; Matt 28:10; Mark 16:7-8; John 16:4
- v8 — Ps 2:11; Mark 16:8; Luke 24:36-41
- v9 — Matt 28:17; Matt 14:33; John 20:28; John 20:14-17; Luke 24:52
- v10 — Rom 8:29; John 20:17; Matt 28:7
- v16 — Matt 26:32; Matt 28:10; Matt 28:7; Mark 16:14
- v18 — John 3:35; 1 Pet 3:22; Matt 11:27; Eph 1:20-22; Heb 2:8
- v19 — Mark 16:15-16; Acts 2:38-39; Acts 1:8; Luke 24:47-48; Acts 19:3-5
- v20 — Isa 41:10; Josh 1:5; Acts 18:9-10; John 14:18-23; Ps 46:7

Mark

Author: John Mark, companion of Paul and Barnabas and later close associate of Peter — Papias (c. AD 125) records that Mark wrote down Peter's preaching about Jesus, explaining the Gospel's eyewitness vividness and Petrine perspective.

Date written: c. AD 55–65, likely the earliest of the four Gospels.

Written to: Primarily a Roman Gentile audience — Mark explains Jewish customs, translates Aramaic phrases, and uses Latin loanwords; he writes for readers who were not raised on the Hebrew Scriptures.

Setting: The Roman empire under Nero or Claudius. The early church is spreading rapidly through persecution. Mark writes to ground his readers in the historical reality of who Jesus is and what He did.

Where this sits historically: Likely written from Rome during or just after Nero's persecution of Christians (AD 64–67) following the Great Fire of Rome, and before the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70.

Contemporaries: Peter and Paul were preaching and being martyred in Rome in this same window, while Matthew, Luke, and the later Pauline epistles (1–2 Timothy, Titus) were taking shape.

Big themes:

- Jesus as the Servant — Mark presents Jesus as the one who came "not to be ministered unto, but to minister" (10:45); there is no birth narrative, no genealogy — only action
- Immediacy — "straightway" (immediately) appears over forty times; Mark's Gospel moves at pace, one event following another with urgent energy
- The authority of Jesus — over demons, disease, nature, and death; every chapter reinforces that this man commands with absolute authority
- The messianic secret — Jesus repeatedly tells those He heals to tell no one; the full identity of the Messiah is only revealed at the cross
- The cross — Mark devotes more proportional space to the passion narrative than any other Gospel; the servant's greatest act is His death

Key passages: Mark 1:1; 1:15; 8:29; 10:45; 16:6

How it fits: Mark is the shortest and most action-driven Gospel — the ideal starting point for someone reading the Gospels for the first time. It captures Peter's preaching, which means it preserves the most direct apostolic eyewitness tradition. The longer ending (16:9–20) is part of the canonical TR text and closes the Gospel with resurrection appearances and the Great Commission.

Chapter 1

John the Baptist preaches in the wilderness and baptizes Jesus in the Jordan, where the Spirit descends and the Father's voice declares Jesus His beloved Son. Jesus calls Simon, Andrew, James, and John, casts out an unclean spirit in the synagogue at Capernaum, heals Simon's mother-in-law, and cleanses a leper.

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| 1 <i>The beginning of the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God;</i> | This is the beginning of the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mark** (MARK) — A Latin name meaning "of Mars" or "defender" — John Mark, the author, was a companion of Paul and Barnabas, and later of Peter, who called him "my son" (1 Peter 5:13).

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| 2 <i>As it is written in the prophets, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.</i> | As it is written in the prophets: "I am sending My messenger before Your face, who will prepare Your way before You." |
| 3 <i>The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.</i> | "A voice crying in the wilderness: 'Prepare the way of the Lord. Make His paths straight.'" |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **John** (JON) — Hebrew Yohanan, "the LORD is gracious" — John the Baptist, son of Zacharias and Elisabeth, the forerunner of Jesus Christ.

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| 4 <i>John did baptize in the wilderness, and preach the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins.</i> | John baptized in the wilderness. He preached a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins. |
| 5 <i>And there went out unto him all the land of Judaea, and they of Jerusalem, and were all baptized of him in the river of Jordan, confessing their sins.</i> | People from all over Judaea and Jerusalem went out to Him. They were all baptized by Him in the river Jordan, confessing their sins. |
| 6 <i>And John was clothed with camel's hair, and with a girdle of a skin about his loins; and he did eat locusts and wild honey;</i> | John wore clothes made of camel's hair, with a leather belt around His waist. He ate locusts and wild honey. |
| 7 <i>And preached, saying, There cometh one mightier than I after me, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to stoop down and unloose.</i> | He preached, saying, "One mightier than I comes after me. I am not worthy to stoop down and untie His sandals." |

- 8 *I indeed have baptized you with water; but he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost.* I have baptized You with water, but He will baptize You with the Holy Ghost.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the old English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is not a mere force — He is God, fully personal, who lives in every believer.*

- 9 *And it came to pass in those days, that Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee, and was baptized of John in Jordan.* In those days Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jesus** (JEE-zus) — *Greek form of Hebrew Yeshua, "the LORD saves" — The Son of God, the Messiah, the central figure of the gospel. He is fully God and fully man.*

- 10 *And straightway coming up out of the water, he saw the heavens opened, and the Spirit like a dove descending upon him:* As He came up out of the water, He immediately saw the heavens opened and the Spirit descending on Him like a dove.
- 11 *And there came a voice from heaven, saying, Thou art my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.* A voice came from heaven: "You are My beloved Son. In You I am well pleased."
- 12 *And immediately the spirit driveth him into the wilderness.* Immediately the Spirit drove Him into the wilderness.
- 13 *And he was there in the wilderness forty days, tempted of Satan; and was with the wild beasts; and the angels ministered unto him.* He was in the wilderness forty days, tempted by Satan. He was with the wild animals, and the angels served Him.
- 14 *Now after that John was put in prison, Jesus came into Galilee, preaching the gospel of the kingdom of God,* After John was put in prison, Jesus came into Galilee preaching the gospel of the kingdom of God.
- 15 *And saying, The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand: repent ye, and believe the gospel.* He said, "The time is fulfilled. The kingdom of God is at hand. Repent and believe the gospel."

- 16 *Now as he walked by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.* As He walked along the Sea of Galilee, He saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Simon** (SY-mun) — Hebrew Simeon, "he has heard" — The apostle later named Peter, a fisherman from Galilee and one of the twelve.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Andrew** (AN-droo) — Greek, "manly" — Brother of Simon Peter, also a fisherman, and one of the twelve apostles.

- 17 *And Jesus said unto them, Come ye after me, and I will make you to become fishers of men.* Jesus said to them, "Follow Me, and I will make You fishers of men."
- 18 *And straightway they forsook their nets, and followed him.* At once they left their nets and followed Him.
- 19 *And when he had gone a little further thence, he saw James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, who also were in the ship mending their nets.* Going a little farther, He saw James the son of Zebedee and his brother John. They were in the boat mending their nets.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **James** (JAYMZ) — Greek form of Hebrew Jacob, "supplanter" or "one who follows at the heel" — Son of Zebedee and brother of John; one of the twelve apostles and part of Jesus' inner circle.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zebedee** (ZEB-uh-dee) — Hebrew, "gift of God" — A Galilean fisherman, father of James and John.

- 20 *And straightway he called them: and they left their father Zebedee in the ship with the hired servants, and went after him.* He called them at once. They left their father Zebedee in the boat with the hired servants and followed Him.
- 21 *And they went into Capernaum; and straightway on the sabbath day he entered into the synagogue, and taught.* They went into Capernaum. On the Sabbath He entered the synagogue and taught.

- 22 *And they were astonished at his doctrine: for he taught them as one that had authority, and not as the scribes.* The people were amazed at his teaching, because he taught them as one with authority and not like the scribes.
- 23 *And there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit; and he cried out,* There was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit. He cried out,
- 24 *Saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art, the Holy One of God.* "Leave us alone! What do You want with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have You come to destroy us? I know who You are — the Holy One of God."
- 25 *And Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him.* Jesus rebuked Him, saying, "Be quiet and come out of Him."
- 26 *And when the unclean spirit had torn him, and cried with a loud voice, he came out of him.* The unclean spirit convulsed the man, cried out with a loud voice, and came out of him.
- 27 *And they were all amazed, insomuch that they questioned among themselves, saying, What thing is this? what new doctrine is this? for with authority commandeth he even the unclean spirits, and they do obey him.* Everyone was so amazed that they asked each other, "What is this? What new teaching is this? He commands even the unclean spirits with authority, and they obey Him."
- 28 *And immediately his fame spread abroad throughout all the region round about Galilee.* His fame spread at once throughout all the surrounding region of Galilee.
- 29 *And forthwith, when they were come out of the synagogue, they entered into the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.* As soon as they left the synagogue, they went into the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.
- 30 *But Simon's wife's mother lay sick of a fever, and anon they tell him of her.* Simon's mother-in-law lay sick with a fever. They told Jesus about her right away.

- 31 *And he came and took her by the hand, and lifted her up; and immediately the fever left her, and she ministered unto them.* He came and took her by the hand and lifted her up. The fever left her at once, and she began to serve them.
- 32 *And at even, when the sun did set, they brought unto him all that were diseased, and them that were possessed with devils.* That evening, when the sun had set, they brought to Him all who were sick and those who were demon-possessed.
- 33 *And all the city was gathered together at the door.* The whole city was gathered at the door.
- 34 *And he healed many that were sick of divers diseases, and cast out many devils; and suffered not the devils to speak, because they knew him.* He healed many who were sick with various diseases and drove out many demons. He did not permit the demons to speak, because they knew who He was.
- 35 *And in the morning, rising up a great while before day, he went out, and departed into a solitary place, and there prayed.* Very early in the morning, while it was still dark, He got up and went out to a solitary place and prayed.
- 36 *And Simon and they that were with him followed after him.* Simon and those with him went searching for him.
- 37 *And when they had found him, they said unto him, All men seek for thee.* When they found Him, they said, "Everyone is looking for You."
- 38 *And he said unto them, Let us go into the next towns, that I may preach there also: for therefore came I forth.* He said to them, "Let us go to the nearby towns so I can preach there also. That is why I have come."
- 39 *And he preached in their synagogues throughout all Galilee, and cast out devils.* He preached in their synagogues throughout all Galilee and drove out demons.
- 40 *And there came a leper to him, beseeching him, and kneeling down to him, and saying unto him, If thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.* A leper came to Him, kneeling down and begging, "If You are willing, You can make me clean."

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| <p>41 <i>And Jesus, moved with compassion, put forth his hand, and touched him, and saith unto him, I will; be thou clean.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And as soon as he had spoken, immediately the leprosy departed from him, and he was cleansed.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And he straitly charged him, and forthwith sent him away;</i></p> <p>44 <i>And saith unto him, See thou say nothing to any man: but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer for thy cleansing those things which Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.</i></p> <p>45 <i>But he went out, and began to publish it much, and to blaze abroad the matter, insomuch that Jesus could no more openly enter into the city, but was without in desert places: and they came to him from every quarter.</i></p> | <p>Jesus was moved with compassion. He reached out and touched Him, saying, "I am willing. Be clean."</p> <p>As soon as He spoke, the leprosy left the man at once and he was cleansed.</p> <p>Jesus gave Him a strict warning and sent Him away at once.</p> <p>He said to him, "Say nothing to anyone. Go, show yourself to the priest and offer what Moses commanded for your cleansing, as a testimony to them."</p> <p>Instead, the man went out and began to spread the news freely, telling everyone about it. As a result, Jesus could no longer openly enter a town. He stayed in the open country, and people came to Him from everywhere.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 John 5:11-12; John 20:31; Matt 3:17; Matt 4:3; Matt 14:33
- v2 — Mal 3:1; Matt 11:10; Luke 1:76; Matt 3:1-11; Luke 1:15-17
- v3 — Isa 40:3-5; Matt 3:3; Luke 3:4-6
- v6 — 2 Kgs 1:8; Lev 11:22; Zech 13:4; Matt 3:4
- v7 — Acts 13:25; Luke 3:16; John 1:27; Matt 3:11
- v8 — Acts 1:5; 1 Cor 12:13; Acts 19:4-6; Acts 2:4; Joel 2:28
- v10 — Luke 3:22; John 1:31-34; Isa 42:1; Isa 64:1; Matt 3:16
- v11 — Isa 42:1; Mark 9:7; Matt 3:17; Ps 2:7
- v15 — Matt 3:2; Acts 2:36-38; Matt 4:17; Eph 1:10; Acts 20:21
- v24 — Matt 8:29; Jas 2:19; Luke 4:34; Acts 3:14; Rev 3:7
- v35 — Luke 6:12; Luke 5:16; Luke 22:39-46; Eph 6:18; Ps 5:3
- v44 — Lev 14:1-32; Luke 17:14; Matt 8:4; 1 Cor 10:11

Chapter 2

Jesus heals a paralytic lowered through the roof, forgiving his sins and proving His authority by the miracle. He calls Levi the tax collector, eats with sinners, and defends His disciples when the Pharisees question them about fasting and plucking grain on the Sabbath.

- 1 *And again he entered into Capernaum after some days; and it was noised that he was in the house.* After some days He returned to Capernaum, and word spread that He was in the house.
- 2 *And straightway many were gathered together, insomuch that there was no room to receive them, no, not so much as about the door: and he preached the word unto them.* So many people gathered that there was no room left, not even at the door. He preached the word to them.
- 3 *And they come unto him, bringing one sick of the palsy, which was borne of four.* Some men came, bringing a paralyzed man carried by four of them.
- 4 *And when they could not come nigh unto him for the press, they uncovered the roof where he was: and when they had broken it up, they let down the bed wherein the sick of the palsy lay.* They could not get near Jesus because of the crowd, so they made an opening in the roof above Him. They broke through and lowered the mat on which the paralyzed man lay.

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| 5 | <i>When Jesus saw their faith, he said unto the sick of the palsy, Son, thy sins be forgiven thee.</i> | When Jesus saw their faith, He said to the paralyzed man, "Son, Your sins are forgiven." |
| 6 | <i>But there were certain of the scribes sitting there, and reasoning in their hearts,</i> | Some scribes were sitting there, reasoning in their hearts: |
| 7 | <i>Why doth this man thus speak blasphemies? who can forgive sins but God only?</i> | "Why does this man speak like this? It is blasphemy! Who can forgive sins but God alone?" |
| 8 | <i>And immediately when Jesus perceived in his spirit that they so reasoned within themselves, he said unto them, Why reason ye these things in your hearts?</i> | Jesus knew in His spirit that they were reasoning this way within themselves. He said to them, "Why are You reasoning these things in Your hearts?" |
| 9 | <i>Whether is it easier to say to the sick of the palsy, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and take up thy bed, and walk?</i> | Which is easier — to say to the paralyzed man, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up, take Your mat, and walk'? |
| 10 | <i>But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (he saith to the sick of the palsy,)</i> | So that You may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins — He said to the paralyzed man: |
| 11 | <i>I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy bed, and go thy way into thine house.</i> | "I tell You, get up, take Your mat, and go home." |
| 12 | <i>And immediately he arose, took up the bed, and went forth before them all; insomuch that they were all amazed, and glorified God, saying, We never saw it on this fashion.</i> | At once the man got up, picked up his mat, and walked out in front of everyone. They were all amazed and glorified God, saying, "We have never seen anything like this." |
| 13 | <i>And he went forth again by the sea side; and all the multitude resorted unto him, and he taught them.</i> | Jesus went out again along the seashore. The whole crowd came to Him and He taught them. |

- 14 *And as he passed by, he saw Levi the son of Alphaeus sitting at the receipt of custom, and said unto him, Follow me. And he arose and followed him.* As He passed by, He saw Levi the son of Alphaeus sitting at the tax collector's booth. He said to Him, "Follow Me." Levi got up and followed Him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Levi** (LEE-vy) — Hebrew, "joined" or "attached" — The tax collector also known as Matthew, son of Alphaeus. He became one of the twelve apostles.

- 15 *And it came to pass, that, as Jesus sat at meat in his house, many publicans and sinners sat also together with Jesus and his disciples: for there were many, and they followed him.* Jesus was reclining at table in Levi's house. Many tax collectors and sinners were eating with Jesus and His disciples, for there were many who followed Him.
- 16 *And when the scribes and Pharisees saw him eat with publicans and sinners, they said unto his disciples, How is it that he eateth and drinketh with publicans and sinners?* When the scribes and Pharisees saw Him eating with tax collectors and sinners, they asked His disciples, "Why does He eat and drink with tax collectors and sinners?"
- 17 *When Jesus heard it, he saith unto them, They that are whole have no need of the physician, but they that are sick: I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.* Jesus heard this and said to them, "Those who are well have no need of a doctor, but those who are sick do. I did not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance."
- 18 *And the disciples of John and of the Pharisees used to fast: and they come and say unto him, Why do the disciples of John and of the Pharisees fast, but thy disciples fast not?* The disciples of John and of the Pharisees were fasting. Some people came and asked Jesus, "Why do the disciples of John and the disciples of the Pharisees fast, but your disciples do not fast?"
- 19 *And Jesus said unto them, Can the children of the bridechamber fast, while the bridegroom is with them? as long as they have the bridegroom with them, they cannot fast.* Jesus said to them, "Can the guests at a wedding fast while the bridegroom is with them? As long as they have the bridegroom with them, they cannot fast."

- 20 *But the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken away from them, and then shall they fast in those days.* The days will come when the bridegroom is taken away from them. Then they will fast in those days.
- 21 *No man also seweth a piece of new cloth on an old garment: else the new piece that filled it up taketh away from the old, and the rent is made worse.* No one sews a patch of unshrunk cloth on an old garment. If He does, the new patch pulls away from the old cloth and the tear becomes worse.
- 22 *And no man putteth new wine into old bottles: else the new wine doth burst the bottles, and the wine is spilled, and the bottles will be marred: but new wine must be put into new bottles.* No one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the wine will burst the skins and both the wine and the skins are ruined. New wine must be poured into new wineskins.
- 23 *And it came to pass, that he went through the corn fields on the sabbath day; and his disciples began, as they went, to pluck the ears of corn.* One Sabbath Jesus was walking through the grain fields, and His disciples began to pick heads of grain as they went.
- 24 *And the Pharisees said unto him, Behold, why do they on the sabbath day that which is not lawful?* The Pharisees said to Him, "Look, why are they doing what is unlawful on the Sabbath?"
- 25 *And he said unto them, Have ye never read what David did, when he had need, and was an hungred, he, and they that were with him?* He said to them, "Have you never read what David did when he was in need and was hungry — he and those who were with him?"
- 26 *How he went into the house of God in the days of Abiathar the high priest, and did eat the shewbread, which is not lawful to eat but for the priests, and gave also to them which were with him?* He entered the house of God in the time of Abiathar the high priest and ate the showbread, which is lawful only for priests to eat. He also gave some to His companions.
- 27 *And he said unto them, The sabbath was made for man, and not man for the sabbath:* He also said to them, "The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath."

28

Therefore the Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.

Therefore the Son of Man is Lord even of the Sabbath.

Words in this chapter:

- meat** — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.
- shewbread** (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'
- Pharisees** (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'
- Levi** (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

- v4** — Luke 5:19; Deut 22:8
- v5** — Matt 9:2; Jas 5:15; Mark 2:9-10; Luke 7:47-50
- v7** — Isa 43:25; Luke 5:21; Dan 9:9; Mic 7:18; Luke 7:49
- v9** — Luke 5:22-25; Matt 9:5
- v10** — Dan 7:13-14; Matt 9:6-8; Acts 5:31; John 5:20-27; Matt 16:13
- v17** — Matt 9:12-13; Luke 15:7; Luke 19:10; Luke 5:31-32; 1 Tim 1:15-16
- v18** — Matt 6:18; Luke 18:12; Matt 9:14-17; Matt 6:16
- v22** — Matt 9:17; Ps 119:83; Josh 9:4; Luke 5:37-38; Josh 9:13
- v23** — Deut 23:24-25; Matt 12:1-8; Luke 6:1-5
- v25** — 1 Sam 21:3-6
- v26** — 2 Sam 8:17; 1 Sam 21:1; Lev 24:5-9
- v27** — Col 2:16; Luke 6:9; Deut 5:14; Ezek 20:12; Isa 58:13

Chapter 3

Jesus heals a man with a withered hand on the Sabbath, provoking the Pharisees to plot against Him. He withdraws to the sea, appoints the twelve apostles, and warns that blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall never be forgiven.

1

And he entered again into the synagogue; and there was a man there which had a withered hand.

He entered the synagogue again. A man with a withered hand was there.

- 2 *And they watched him, whether he would heal him on the sabbath day; that they might accuse him.* They watched Jesus closely to see whether He would heal the man on the Sabbath, looking for a reason to accuse Him.
- 3 *And he saith unto the man which had the withered hand, Stand forth.* He said to the man with the withered hand, "Step forward."
- 4 *And he saith unto them, Is it lawful to do good on the sabbath days, or to do evil? to save life, or to kill? But they held their peace.* Then He said to them, "Which is lawful on the Sabbath — to do good or to do evil? To save life or to kill?" They were silent.
- 5 *And when he had looked round about on them with anger, being grieved for the hardness of their hearts, he saith unto the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it out: and his hand was restored whole as the other.* He looked around at them with anger, deeply grieved at their hardness of heart. He said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He stretched it out, and his hand was completely restored.
- 6 *And the Pharisees went forth, and straightway took counsel with the Herodians against him, how they might destroy him.* The Pharisees went out at once and began plotting with the Herodians against Jesus, looking for a way to destroy Him.
- 7 *But Jesus withdrew himself with his disciples to the sea: and a great multitude from Galilee followed him, and from Judaea,*
- 8 *And from Jerusalem, and from Idumaea, and from beyond Jordan; and they about Tyre and Sidon, a great multitude, when they had heard what great things he did, came unto him.* People came from Judaea, Jerusalem, Idumaea, and from beyond the Jordan. Those from the region of Tyre and Sidon — a great crowd — came to Him when they heard what great things He was doing.
- 9 *And he spake to his disciples, that a small ship should wait on him because of the multitude, lest they should throng him.* He told His disciples to have a small boat ready for Him because of the crowd, so they would not crush Him.

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| 10 <i>For he had healed many; insomuch that they pressed upon him for to touch him, as many as had plagues.</i> | He had healed many, and those who had diseases were pressing around Him trying to touch Him. |
| 11 <i>And unclean spirits, when they saw him, fell down before him, and cried, saying, Thou art the Son of God.</i> | Whenever unclean spirits saw Him, they fell down before Him and cried out, "You are the Son of God." |
| 12 <i>And he straitly charged them that they should not make him known.</i> | He sternly warned them not to make Him known. |
| 13 <i>And he goeth up into a mountain, and calleth unto him whom he would: and they came unto him.</i> | He went up on a mountain and called to Him those He wanted. They came to Him. |
| 14 <i>And he ordained twelve, that they should be with him, and that he might send them forth to preach,</i> | He appointed twelve — that they might be with Him and that He might send them out to preach |
| 15 <i>And to have power to heal sicknesses, and to cast out devils:</i> | and to have authority to heal sicknesses and cast out demons. |
| 16 <i>And Simon he surnamed Peter;</i> | He appointed Simon, to whom he gave the name Peter; |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Peter** (PEE-ter) — Greek Petros, "rock" — The new name Jesus gave to Simon. He became the leading apostle and a pillar of the early church.

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| 17 <i>And James the son of Zebedee, and John the brother of James; and he surnamed them Boanerges, which is, The sons of thunder:</i> | James the son of Zebedee and John the brother of James — He surnamed them Boanerges, which means "Sons of Thunder"; |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Boanerges** (boh-ah-NER-geez) — Aramaic, "sons of thunder" — The nickname Jesus gave to James and John, possibly reflecting their bold, fiery temperament.

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| 18 <i>And Andrew, and Philip, and Bartholomew, and Matthew, and Thomas, and James the son of Alphaeus, and Thaddaeus, and Simon the Canaanite,</i> | Andrew, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thomas, James the son of Alphaeus, Thaddaeus, and Simon the Canaanite; |
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- 19 *And Judas Iscariot, which also betrayed him: and they went into an house.* and Judas Iscariot, who betrayed him. They went into a house.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Judas Iscariot** (JOO-dus is-KAIR-ee-ut) — "Judas" is Greek for Hebrew Judah, "praise"; "Iscariot" likely means "man of Kerioth," a town in Judah — The apostle who betrayed Jesus for thirty pieces of silver.

- 20 *And the multitude cometh together again, so that they could not so much as eat bread.* The crowd gathered again so that Jesus and His disciples could not even eat.
- 21 *And when his friends heard of it, they went out to lay hold on him: for they said, He is beside himself.* When His own family heard about this, they went to take charge of Him, for they said, "He is out of His mind."
- 22 *And the scribes which came down from Jerusalem said, He hath Beelzebub, and by the prince of the devils casteth he out devils.* The scribes who came down from Jerusalem said, "He has Beelzebub, and by the prince of demons he casts out demons."
- 23 *And he called them unto him, and said unto them in parables, How can Satan cast out Satan?* Jesus called them to Him and spoke to them in parables: "How can Satan cast out Satan?"
- 24 *And if a kingdom be divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand.* If a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand.
- 25 *And if a house be divided against itself, that house cannot stand.* If a house is divided against itself, that house cannot stand.
- 26 *And if Satan rise up against himself, and be divided, he cannot stand, but hath an end.* If Satan has risen up against himself and is divided, he cannot stand — his end has come.
- 27 *No man can enter into a strong man's house, and spoil his goods, except he will first bind the strong man; and then he will spoil his house.* No one can enter a strong man's house and plunder his goods unless he first ties up the strong man. Then he can plunder his house.
- 28 *Verily I say unto you, All sins shall be forgiven unto the sons of men, and blasphemies wherewith soever they shall blaspheme:* Truly I tell you, all sins will be forgiven the sons of men, and whatever blasphemies they utter.

- 29 *But he that shall blaspheme against the Holy Ghost hath never forgiveness, but is in danger of eternal damnation:* But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Ghost never has forgiveness. He is in danger of eternal damnation.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. "Eternal damnation" means there is no appeal and no end — it is the irreversible consequence of rejecting God's mercy.

- 30 *Because they said, He hath an unclean spirit.* He said this because they had said, "He has an unclean spirit."
- 31 *There came then his brethren and his mother, and, standing without, sent unto him, calling him.* Then His brothers and His mother came. Standing outside, they sent word to Him, calling for Him.
- 32 *And the multitude sat about him, and they said unto him, Behold, thy mother and thy brethren without seek for thee.* A crowd was sitting around Him. They told Him, "Your mother and Your brothers are outside looking for You."
- 33 *And he answered them, saying, Who is my mother, or my brethren?* He answered them, "Who is My mother and My brothers?"
- 34 *And he looked round about on them which sat about him, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!* He looked at those sitting in a circle around Him and said, "Here are My mother and My brothers."
- 35 *For whosoever shall do the will of God, the same is my brother, and my sister, and mother.* Whoever does the will of God is My brother, My sister, and My mother.

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 12:9-14; Luke 6:6-11; Mark 1:21
v2 — Ps 37:32; Luke 6:7; Luke 14:1; Luke 20:20; Luke 11:53-54
v11 — Luke 4:41; Luke 8:28; Mark 1:23-24; Matt 8:29; Jas 2:19
v12 — Matt 12:16; Mark 1:34; Mark 1:25
v13 — Luke 9:1; Luke 6:12-16; Matt 10:1-4; Mark 6:7; Matt 5:1
v21 — Acts 26:24; John 10:20; Mark 3:31; John 7:3-10

v22 — Matt 10:25; Matt 15:1; Matt 9:34; Matt 12:24

v25 — Jas 3:16; Gal 5:15; Ps 133:1; Gen 37:4; Gen 13:7-8

v27 — Isa 49:24-26; Matt 12:29; Luke 11:21-23; Eph 6:10-13; Rev 20:1-3

v28 — Luke 12:10; Matt 12:31-32; 1 John 5:16; Mark 3:28-30

v29 — Matt 12:31-32; Luke 12:10

v35 — 1 John 2:17; Matt 7:21; 1 John 3:22-23

Chapter 4

Jesus teaches the crowds from a boat, telling the parable of the sower, the parable of the seed growing secretly, and the parable of the mustard seed. He calms a violent storm on the sea, and the disciples marvel, asking, 'What manner of man is this, that even the wind and the sea obey Him?'

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| 1 | <i>And he began again to teach by the sea side: and there was gathered unto him a great multitude, so that he entered into a ship, and sat in the sea; and the whole multitude was by the sea on the land.</i> | Again He began to teach beside the sea. Such a large crowd gathered around Him that He got into a boat and sat in it on the sea. The whole crowd was on the shore facing the water. |
| 2 | <i>And he taught them many things by parables, and said unto them in his doctrine,</i> | He taught them many things by parables, and in His teaching He said: |
| 3 | <i>Hearken; Behold, there went out a sower to sow:</i> | "Listen! A farmer went out to sow His seed." |
| 4 | <i>And it came to pass, as he sowed, some fell by the way side, and the fowls of the air came and devoured it up.</i> | As He sowed, some seed fell along the path. The birds came and ate it up. |
| 5 | <i>And some fell on stony ground, where it had not much earth; and immediately it sprang up, because it had no depth of earth:</i> | Some fell on rocky ground where the soil was shallow. It sprang up quickly because it had no depth of soil. |
| 6 | <i>But when the sun was up, it was scorched; and because it had no root, it withered away.</i> | When the sun rose, it was scorched. Because it had no root, it withered away. |

- 7 *And some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up, and choked it, and it yielded no fruit.* Some fell among thorns. The thorns grew up, choked the plant, and it produced no fruit.
- 8 *And other fell on good ground, and did yield fruit that sprang up and increased; and brought forth, some thirty, and some sixty, and some an hundred.* Still other seed fell on good ground. It came up, grew, and produced a crop — some thirty, some sixty, and some a hundred times what was sown.
- 9 *And he said unto them, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.* He said, "Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear."
- 10 *And when he was alone, they that were about him with the twelve asked of him the parable.* When He was alone, those around Him with the twelve asked Him about the parables.
- 11 *And he said unto them, Unto you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables:* He said to them, "To You it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God. But to those outside, everything comes in parables."
- 12 *That seeing they may see, and not perceive; and hearing they may hear, and not understand; lest at any time they should be converted, and their sins should be forgiven them.* This is so that seeing they may see and not understand, and hearing they may hear and not grasp it — lest they should turn and their sins be forgiven.
- 13 *And he said unto them, Know ye not this parable? and how then will ye know all parables?* He said to them, "Don't You understand this parable? Then how will You understand any of the parables?"
- 14 *The sower soweth the word.* The farmer sows the word.
- 15 *And these are they by the way side, where the word is sown; but when they have heard, Satan cometh immediately, and taketh away the word that was sown in their hearts.* These are the ones along the path where the word is sown: when they hear it, Satan comes at once and takes away the word that was sown in them.

- 16 *And these are they likewise which are sown on stony ground; who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive it with gladness;* These are the ones sown on rocky ground. When they hear the word, they immediately receive it with joy.
- 17 *And have no root in themselves, and so endure but for a time: afterward, when affliction or persecution ariseth for the word's sake, immediately they are offended.* But they have no root in themselves and last only a short time. When trouble or persecution comes because of the word, they quickly fall away.
- 18 *And these are they which are sown among thorns; such as hear the word,* Others are like seed sown among thorns. They hear the word,
- 19 *And the cares of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in, choke the word, and it becometh unfruitful.* but the worries of this life, the deceitfulness of riches, and the desire for other things come in and choke the word, making it unfruitful.
- 20 *And these are they which are sown on good ground; such as hear the word, and receive it, and bring forth fruit, some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred.* And these are the ones sown on good ground — those who hear the word, receive it, and bear fruit: some thirty, some sixty, and some a hundred times.
- 21 *And he said unto them, Is a candle brought to be put under a bushel, or under a bed? and not to be set on a candlestick?* He said to them, "Is a lamp brought in to be put under a basket or under a bed? Is it not set on a lampstand?"
- 22 *For there is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested; neither was any thing kept secret, but that it should come abroad.* There is nothing hidden that will not be revealed, and nothing kept secret that will not come to light.
- 23 *If any man have ears to hear, let him hear.* If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear.

- 24 *And he said unto them, Take heed what ye hear: with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you: and unto you that hear shall more be given.* He said to them, "Pay careful attention to what you hear. The measure you give will be the measure you receive — and more will be added to you.
- 25 *For he that hath, to him shall be given: and he that hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he hath.* To the one who has, more will be given. From the one who has nothing, even what he has will be taken away."
- 26 *And he said, So is the kingdom of God, as if a man should cast seed into the ground;* He also said, "The kingdom of God is like a man who scatters seed on the ground.
- 27 *And should sleep, and rise night and day, and the seed should spring and grow up, he knoweth not how.* He sleeps and rises night and day. The seed sprouts and grows — he does not know how.
- 28 *For the earth bringeth forth fruit of herself; first the blade, then the ear, after that the full corn in the ear.* The earth produces by itself: first the blade, then the head of grain, then the full grain in the head.
- 29 *But when the fruit is brought forth, immediately he putteth in the sickle, because the harvest is come.* When the grain is ripe, he puts in the sickle at once, because the harvest has come."
- 30 *And he said, Whereunto shall we liken the kingdom of God? or with what comparison shall we compare it?* He said, "To what shall we compare the kingdom of God? What parable shall we use for it?"
- 31 *It is like a grain of mustard seed, which, when it is sown in the earth, is less than all the seeds that be in the earth:* "It is like a mustard seed. When it is sown in the ground, it is the smallest of all seeds on the earth.
- 32 *But when it is sown, it groweth up, and becometh greater than all herbs, and shooteth out great branches; so that the fowls of the air may lodge under the shadow of it.* Yet when it is sown, it grows up and becomes greater than all garden plants. It puts out large branches, so that the birds of the air can nest in its shade."

- 33 *And with many such parables spake he the word unto them, as they were able to hear it.* With many such parables He spoke the word to them, as they were able to understand it.
- 34 *But without a parable spake he not unto them: and when they were alone, he expounded all things to his disciples.* He did not speak to them without a parable. But when He was alone with His disciples, He explained everything to them.
- 35 *And the same day, when the even was come, he saith unto them, Let us pass over unto the other side.* On that same day, when evening came, He said to them, "Let us cross to the other side."
- 36 *And when they had sent away the multitude, they took him even as he was in the ship. And there were also with him other little ships.* They dismissed the crowd and took Him along, just as He was, in the boat. Other boats were with Him.
- 37 *And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that it was now full.* A great windstorm arose. The waves beat into the boat so that it was nearly full of water.
- 38 *And he was in the hinder part of the ship, asleep on a pillow: and they awake him, and say unto him, Master, carest thou not that we perish?* Jesus was in the stern, asleep on a cushion. They woke Him and said, "Master, don't You care that we are perishing?"
- 39 *And he arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, Peace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm.* He got up and rebuked the wind. He said to the sea, "Peace! Be still." The wind died down and there was a great calm.
- 40 *And he said unto them, Why are ye so fearful? how is it that ye have no faith?* He said to them, "Why are You so fearful? Do You still have no faith?"
- 41 *And they feared exceedingly, and said one to another, What manner of man is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?* They were greatly afraid and said to one another, "Who is this, that even the wind and the sea obey Him?"

Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Cross-References:

- v12 — Isa 6:9-10; Isa 44:18; Matt 13:14-15; Jer 5:21; Deut 29:4
- v15 — 1 Pet 5:8; Matt 13:19; Luke 8:12; 2 Cor 4:3-4; Mark 4:4
- v19 — 1 John 2:15-17; 1 Tim 6:9-10; 1 Tim 6:17; Phil 4:6; Matt 19:23
- v20 — Col 1:10; Luke 8:15; John 15:4-5; Matt 13:23; Mark 4:8
- v21 — Matt 5:15; Luke 11:33; Luke 8:16; Isa 60:1-3; Eph 5:3-15
- v22 — Luke 8:17; Eccl 12:14; 1 Cor 4:5; Matt 10:26-27; Ps 78:2-4
- v24 — Heb 2:1; Luke 8:18; Matt 7:2; 2 Cor 9:6; Acts 17:11
- v25 — Matt 13:12; Luke 8:18; Matt 25:28-29; John 15:2; Luke 19:24-26
- v32 — Dan 4:20-22; Dan 4:10-14; Ezek 31:3-10; Ps 80:9-11; Ps 91:1
- v35 — Matt 8:18; Luke 8:25; Luke 8:22; Matt 8:23-27; Matt 14:22
- v39 — Ps 107:29; Ps 89:9; Ps 65:7; Ps 29:10; Jer 5:22
- v40 — Luke 8:25; Matt 8:26; Matt 14:31; Isa 43:2; Matt 16:8

Chapter 5

Jesus casts a legion of demons out of a man among the tombs in the country of the Gadarenes, sending them into a herd of swine. He heals a woman with a twelve-year flow of blood who touches His garment, and raises Jairus's daughter from the dead.

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| 1 | <i>And they came over unto the other side of the sea, into the country of the Gadarenes.</i> | They crossed to the other side of the sea, into the region of the Gadarenes. |
| 2 | <i>And when he was come out of the ship, immediately there met him out of the tombs a man with an unclean spirit,</i> | As Jesus got out of the boat, a man with an unclean spirit came from the tombs to meet Him. |
| 3 | <i>Who had his dwelling among the tombs; and no man could bind him, no, not with chains:</i> | This man lived among the tombs. No one could bind him anymore, not even with chains. |
| 4 | <i>Because that he had been often bound with fetters and chains, and the chains had been plucked asunder by him, and the fetters broken in pieces: neither could any man tame him.</i> | He had often been bound with shackles and chains, but he tore the chains apart and broke the shackles in pieces. No one was strong enough to tame him. |

- 5 *And always, night and day, he was in the mountains, and in the tombs, crying, and cutting himself with stones.* Night and day he wandered among the tombs and in the hills, crying out and cutting himself with stones.
- 6 *But when he saw Jesus afar off, he ran and worshipped him,* When He saw Jesus from a distance, He ran and worshipped Him.
- 7 *And cried with a loud voice, and said, What have I to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of the most high God? I adjure thee by God, that thou torment me not.* He cried out in a loud voice, "What do You want with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? In God's name, I beg You — don't torment me!"
- 8 *For he said unto him, Come out of the man, thou unclean spirit.* For Jesus had said to Him, "Come out of the man, you unclean spirit."
- 9 *And he asked him, What is thy name? And he answered, saying, My name is Legion: for we are many.* Jesus asked Him, "What is Your name?" He answered, "My name is Legion, for we are many."
- 10 *And he besought him much that he would not send them away out of the country.* He begged Jesus repeatedly not to send them out of the region.
- 11 *Now there was there nigh unto the mountains a great herd of swine feeding.* A large herd of pigs was feeding on the hillside nearby.
- 12 *And all the devils besought him, saying, Send us into the swine, that we may enter into them.* The demons begged Him, "Send us into the pigs. Let us enter them."
- 13 *And forthwith Jesus gave them leave. And the unclean spirits went out, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the sea, (they were about two thousand;) and were choked in the sea.* Jesus gave them permission. The unclean spirits came out and entered the pigs, and the herd — about two thousand — rushed down the steep bank into the sea and drowned.

- 14 *And they that fed the swine fled, and told it in the city, and in the country. And they went out to see what it was that was done.* Those who tended the pigs fled and spread the news in the town and countryside. People came out to see what had happened.
- 15 *And they come to Jesus, and see him that was possessed with the devil, and had the legion, sitting, and clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid.* They came to Jesus and saw the man who had been possessed by the legion of demons sitting there, dressed and in His right mind. They were afraid.
- 16 *And they that saw it told them how it befell to him that was possessed with the devil, and also concerning the swine.* Those who had seen it described what had happened to the man who had been demon-possessed, and also about the pigs.
- 17 *And they began to pray him to depart out of their coasts.* Then they began to beg Jesus to leave their region.
- 18 *And when he was come into the ship, he that had been possessed with the devil prayed him that he might be with him.* As Jesus was getting into the boat, the man who had been possessed begged to go with him.
- 19 *Howbeit Jesus suffered him not, but saith unto him, Go home to thy friends, and tell them how great things the Lord hath done for thee, and hath had compassion on thee.* But Jesus would not allow it. He said to Him, "Go home to Your family and tell them how much the Lord has done for You and how He had compassion on You."
- 20 *And he departed, and began to publish in Decapolis how great things Jesus had done for him: and all men did marvel.* The man went away and began to tell in Decapolis how much Jesus had done for Him. Everyone was amazed.
- 21 *And when Jesus was passed over again by ship unto the other side, much people gathered unto him: and he was nigh unto the sea.* When Jesus had crossed back by boat to the other side, a large crowd gathered around Him while He was by the sea.

- 22 *And, behold, there cometh one of the rulers of the synagogue, Jairus by name; and when he saw him, he fell at his feet,* One of the rulers of the synagogue, named Jairus, came. When He saw Jesus, He fell at His feet

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jairus** (JAY-ih-rus) — Greek form of Hebrew Yair, "he enlightens" — A synagogue ruler whose twelve-year-old daughter Jesus raised from the dead.

- 23 *And besought him greatly, saying, My little daughter lieth at the point of death: I pray thee, come and lay thy hands on her, that she may be healed; and she shall live.* and pleaded with Him greatly, saying, "My little daughter is at the point of death. Please come and lay Your hands on her so she may be healed and live."
- 24 *And Jesus went with him; and much people followed him, and thronged him.* Jesus went with Him. A large crowd followed and pressed around Him.
- 25 *And a certain woman, which had an issue of blood twelve years,* A woman who had suffered a blood discharge for twelve years
- 26 *And had suffered many things of many physicians, and had spent all that she had, and was nothing bettered, but rather grew worse,* had suffered greatly under many doctors. She had spent all she had, and instead of getting better she grew worse.
- 27 *When she had heard of Jesus, came in the press behind, and touched his garment.* Having heard about Jesus, she came up behind Him in the crowd and touched His garment.
- 28 *For she said, If I may touch but his clothes, I shall be whole.* For she said, "If I touch even His clothes, I will be healed."
- 29 *And straightway the fountain of her blood was dried up; and she felt in her body that she was healed of that plague.* At once the flow of her blood stopped. She felt in her body that she was healed of her affliction.
- 30 *And Jesus, immediately knowing in himself that virtue had gone out of him, turned him about in the press, and said, Who touched my clothes?* Jesus immediately knew that power had gone out from Him. He turned around in the crowd and asked, "Who touched My clothes?"

- 31 *And his disciples said unto him, Thou seest the multitude thronging thee, and sayest thou, Who touched me?* His disciples said to Him, "You see the crowd pressing around You, and yet You ask, 'Who touched Me?'"
- 32 *And he looked round about to see her that had done this thing.* He kept looking around to see who had done it.
- 33 *But the woman fearing and trembling, knowing what was done in her, came and fell down before him, and told him all the truth.* The woman, knowing what had happened to her, came with fear and trembling. She fell down before Him and told Him the whole truth.
- 34 *And he said unto her, Daughter, thy faith hath made thee whole; go in peace, and be whole of thy plague.* He said to her, "Daughter, your faith has made you well. Go in peace and be free from your affliction."
- 35 *While he yet spake, there came from the ruler of the synagogue's house certain which said, Thy daughter is dead: why troublest thou the Master any further?* While He was still speaking, some people came from the ruler of the synagogue's house and said, "Your daughter is dead. Why trouble the Master any further?"
- 36 *As soon as Jesus heard the word that was spoken, he saith unto the ruler of the synagogue, Be not afraid, only believe.* Jesus overheard what they said. He told the synagogue ruler, "Don't be afraid. Just believe."
- 37 *And he suffered no man to follow him, save Peter, and James, and John the brother of James.* He allowed no one to follow him except Peter, James, and John the brother of James.
- 38 *And he cometh to the house of the ruler of the synagogue, and seeth the tumult, and them that wept and wailed greatly.* When they arrived at the house of the synagogue ruler, Jesus saw the commotion — people weeping and wailing loudly.
- 39 *And when he was come in, he saith unto them, Why make ye this ado, and weep? the damsel is not dead, but sleepeth.* He went in and said to them, "Why all this commotion and weeping? The child is not dead but sleeping."

- 40 *And they laughed him to scorn. But when he had put them all out, he taketh the father and the mother of the damsel, and them that were with him, and entereth in where the damsel was lying.* They laughed at Him. But He put them all out. He took the child's father and mother and those who were with Him, and went in where the child was lying.
- 41 *And he took the damsel by the hand, and said unto her, Talitha cumi; which is, being interpreted, Damsel, I say unto thee, arise.* He took the child by the hand and said to her, "Talitha cumi," which means, "Little girl, I say to You, arise."
- 42 *And straightway the damsel arose, and walked; for she was of the age of twelve years. And they were astonished with a great astonishment.* The girl got up at once and began to walk around. She was twelve years old. They were completely astonished.
- 43 *And he charged them straitly that no man should know it; and commanded that something should be given her to eat.* He gave them strict orders that no one should know about this, and told them to give her something to eat.

Words in this chapter:

Talitha cumi (*TAL-ih-thah KOO-mee*) — Aramaic words spoken by Jesus meaning 'Little girl, I say to you, arise' — the exact words He used to raise Jairus's daughter.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Luke 8:26-39; Matt 8:28-34; Mark 4:35
v7 — Matt 8:29; Acts 16:17; Matt 26:63; Jude 1:6
v15 — Col 1:13; 2 Tim 1:7; 1 Sam 6:20-21; Isa 49:24-25; Mark 5:9
v19 — Ps 66:16; John 4:29
v22 — Luke 13:14; Acts 18:8; Mark 5:35-36; Acts 18:17; Acts 13:15
v25 — Lev 15:25-27; Luke 8:43-44; Matt 9:20-22; Lev 15:19-20; John 5:5-6
v27 — Acts 19:12; Matt 14:36; Acts 5:15; Mark 6:56
v29 — Mark 5:34; Ps 103:3; Ps 30:2; Mark 3:10; Ex 15:26
v30 — Luke 6:19; Luke 8:46; Luke 5:17
v34 — Luke 8:48; Matt 9:22; Luke 7:50; Luke 18:42; Mark 5:29
v36 — Luke 8:50; Matt 9:28-29; John 11:40; Mark 9:23; Rom 4:18-24
v41 — Mark 1:31; Luke 7:14-15; John 5:28-29; Luke 8:54-55; Acts 9:40-41

Chapter 6

Jesus sends the twelve apostles out two by two with authority over unclean spirits. Herod beheads John the Baptist in prison. Jesus feeds five thousand men with five loaves and two fish, then walks on the sea to His disciples.

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| 1 <i>And he went out from thence, and came into his own country; and his disciples follow him.</i> | Jesus left there and went to His hometown. His disciples followed Him. |
| 2 <i>And when the sabbath day was come, he began to teach in the synagogue: and many hearing him were astonished, saying, From whence hath this man these things? and what wisdom is this which is given unto him, that even such mighty works are wrought by his hands?</i> | When the Sabbath came, He began to teach in the synagogue. Many who heard Him were astonished. "Where did this man get all this?" they asked. "What wisdom has been given to Him? How are such miracles done by His hands?" |
| 3 <i>Is not this the carpenter, the son of Mary, the brother of James, and Joses, and of Juda, and Simon? and are not his sisters here with us? And they were offended at him.</i> | "Is this not the carpenter, the son of Mary and the brother of James, Joses, Juda, and Simon? Are not his sisters here with us?" They were offended at Him. |
| 4 <i>But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, but in his own country, and among his own kin, and in his own house.</i> | Jesus said to them, "A prophet is not without honor except in His own hometown, among His own relatives, and in His own house." |
| 5 <i>And he could there do no mighty work, save that he laid his hands upon a few sick folk, and healed them.</i> | He could do no mighty work there, except that He laid His hands on a few sick people and healed them. |
| 6 <i>And he marvelled because of their unbelief. And he went round about the villages, teaching.</i> | He was amazed at their unbelief. Then He went around teaching from village to village. |
| 7 <i>And he called unto him the twelve, and began to send them forth by two and two; and gave them power over unclean spirits;</i> | He called the twelve and began to send them out two by two. He gave them authority over unclean spirits. |

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| <p>8 <i>And commanded them that they should take nothing for their journey, save a staff only; no scrip, no bread, no money in their purse:</i></p> <p>9 <i>But be shod with sandals; and not put on two coats.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And he said unto them, In what place soever ye enter into an house, there abide till ye depart from that place.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear you, when ye depart thence, shake off the dust under your feet for a testimony against them. Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And they went out, and preached that men should repent.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And they cast out many devils, and anointed with oil many that were sick, and healed them.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And king Herod heard of him; (for his name was spread abroad:) and he said, That John the Baptist was risen from the dead, and therefore mighty works do shew forth themselves in him.</i></p> | <p>He instructed them to take nothing for the journey except a staff — no bag, no bread, no money in their belt.</p> <p>They were to wear sandals but not take an extra shirt.</p> <p>He said to them, "Whenever You enter a house, stay there until You leave that town."</p> <p>If any place refuses to receive You or listen to You, shake off the dust from Your feet when You leave, as a testimony against them. Truly I tell You, it will be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that town.</p> <p>They went out and preached that people should repent.</p> <p>They drove out many demons and anointed many sick people with oil and healed them.</p> <p>King Herod heard about Jesus, for His name had become well known. Herod said, "John the Baptist has been raised from the dead. That is why miraculous powers are at work in Him."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Herod** (HEHR-ud) — Greek, "son of a hero" — Herod Antipas, tetrarch of Galilee. He imprisoned and beheaded John the Baptist.

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| <p>15 <i>Others said, That it is Elias. And others said, That it is a prophet, or as one of the prophets.</i></p> | <p>Others said, "He is Elijah." Still others said, "He is a prophet, like one of the prophets of old."</p> |
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- 16 *But when Herod heard thereof, he said, It is John, whom I beheaded: he is risen from the dead.* When Herod heard this he said, "John, whom I beheaded — he has been raised from the dead."
- 17 *For Herod himself had sent forth and laid hold upon John, and bound him in prison for Herodias' sake, his brother Philip's wife: for he had married her.* For Herod himself had sent men to arrest John and had him bound in prison. He did this because of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife, whom Herod had married.
- 18 *For John had said unto Herod, It is not lawful for thee to have thy brother's wife.* John had told Herod, "It is not lawful for you to have your brother's wife."
- 19 *Therefore Herodias had a quarrel against him, and would have killed him; but she could not:* So Herodias had a grudge against John and wanted to kill him, but she could not.
- 20 *For Herod feared John, knowing that he was a just man and an holy man, and observed him; and when he heard him, he did many things, and heard him gladly.* Herod feared John, knowing that he was a just man and a holy man. He kept him safe. When Herod heard him, he did many things, and listened to him gladly.
- 21 *And when a convenient day was come, that Herod on his birthday made a supper to his lords, high captains, and chief estates of Galilee;* A suitable day came when Herod on his birthday gave a banquet for his nobles, military commanders, and the leading men of Galilee.
- 22 *And when the daughter of the said Herodias came in, and danced, and pleased Herod and them that sat with him, the king said unto the damsel, Ask of me whatsoever thou wilt, and I will give it thee.* When the daughter of Herodias came in and danced, she pleased Herod and his guests. The king said to the girl, "Ask me for whatever you want and I will give it to you."
- 23 *And he sware unto her, Whatsoever thou shalt ask of me, I will give it thee, unto the half of my kingdom.* He swore to her, "Whatever you ask, I will give you — up to half my kingdom."

- 24 *And she went forth, and said unto her mother, What shall I ask? And she said, The head of John the Baptist.* She went out and said to her mother, "What shall I ask for?" Her mother said, "The head of John the Baptist."
- 25 *And she came in straightway with haste unto the king, and asked, saying, I will that thou give me by and by in a charger the head of John the Baptist.* She came back in at once to the king and asked, "I want you to give me right now the head of John the Baptist on a platter."
- 26 *And the king was exceeding sorry; yet for his oath's sake, and for their sakes which sat with him, he would not reject her.* The king was deeply sorry, but because of his oath and his guests he did not want to refuse her.
- 27 *And immediately the king sent an executioner, and commanded his head to be brought: and he went and beheaded him in the prison,* He immediately sent an executioner with orders to bring John's head. The man went and beheaded John in the prison
- 28 *And brought his head in a charger, and gave it to the damsel: and the damsel gave it to her mother.* and brought his head on a platter. He gave it to the girl, and the girl gave it to her mother.
- 29 *And when his disciples heard of it, they came and took up his corpse, and laid it in a tomb.* When John's disciples heard about this, they came and took his body and laid it in a tomb.
- 30 *And the apostles gathered themselves together unto Jesus, and told him all things, both what they had done, and what they had taught.* The apostles gathered around Jesus and reported to Him all they had done and taught.
- 31 *And he said unto them, Come ye yourselves apart into a desert place, and rest a while: for there were many coming and going, and they had no leisure so much as to eat.* He said to them, "Come away by yourselves to a quiet place and rest a while." So many people were coming and going that they did not even have time to eat.
- 32 *And they departed into a desert place by ship privately.* They went away by boat to a solitary place by themselves.

- 33 *And the people saw them departing, and many knew him, and ran afoot thither out of all cities, and outwent them, and came together unto him.* But many people saw them leaving and recognized them. They ran on foot from all the towns and arrived ahead of them.
- 34 *And Jesus, when he came out, saw much people, and was moved with compassion toward them, because they were as sheep not having a shepherd: and he began to teach them many things.* When Jesus landed and saw the large crowd, He had compassion on them because they were like sheep without a shepherd. He began to teach them many things.
- 35 *And when the day was now far spent, his disciples came unto him, and said, This is a desert place, and now the time is far passed:* When it was already late in the day, His disciples came to Him and said, "This is a remote place and it is already very late."
- 36 *Send them away, that they may go into the country round about, and into the villages, and buy themselves bread: for they have nothing to eat.* "Send the people away so they can go to the surrounding countryside and villages and buy themselves something to eat."
- 37 *He answered and said unto them, Give ye them to eat. And they say unto him, Shall we go and buy two hundred pennyworth of bread, and give them to eat?* He answered, "You give them something to eat." They said to Him, "Should we go and spend two hundred denarii on bread and give it to them to eat?"
- 38 *He saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? go and see. And when they knew, they say, Five, and two fishes.* He said, "How many loaves do You have? Go and see." When they found out, they said, "Five — and two fish."
- 39 *And he commanded them to make all sit down by companies upon the green grass.* He directed them to have all the people sit down in groups on the green grass.
- 40 *And they sat down in ranks, by hundreds, and by fifties.* They sat down in groups of hundreds and fifties.

- 41 *And when he had taken the five loaves and the two fishes, he looked up to heaven, and blessed, and brake the loaves, and gave them to his disciples to set before them; and the two fishes divided he among them all.* Taking the five loaves and the two fish, He looked up to heaven and gave thanks. He broke the loaves and gave them to His disciples to set before the people. He divided the two fish among them all.
- 42 *And they did all eat, and were filled.* They all ate and were satisfied.
- 43 *And they took up twelve baskets full of the fragments, and of the fishes.* The disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces of bread and fish.
- 44 *And they that did eat of the loaves were about five thousand men.* The number of men who had eaten was about five thousand.
- 45 *And straightway he constrained his disciples to get into the ship, and to go to the other side before unto Bethsaida, while he sent away the people.* At once He made His disciples get into the boat and go ahead of Him to Bethsaida, while He dismissed the crowd.
- 46 *And when he had sent them away, he departed into a mountain to pray.* After He had sent them away, He went up on a mountain to pray.
- 47 *And when even was come, the ship was in the midst of the sea, and he alone on the land.* When evening came, the boat was in the middle of the sea and He was alone on land.
- 48 *And he saw them toiling in rowing; for the wind was contrary unto them: and about the fourth watch of the night he cometh unto them, walking upon the sea, and would have passed by them.* He saw them straining at the oars, because the wind was against them. Shortly before dawn He came to them, walking on the sea. He was about to pass by them.
- 49 *But when they saw him walking upon the sea, they supposed it had been a spirit, and cried out:* When they saw Him walking on the sea, they thought He was a ghost and cried out.

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| <p>50 <i>For they all saw him, and were troubled. And immediately he talked with them, and saith unto them, Be of good cheer: it is I; be not afraid.</i></p> <p>51 <i>And he went up unto them into the ship; and the wind ceased: and they were sore amazed in themselves beyond measure, and wondered.</i></p> <p>52 <i>For they considered not the miracle of the loaves: for their heart was hardened.</i></p> <p>53 <i>And when they had passed over, they came into the land of Gennesaret, and drew to the shore.</i></p> <p>54 <i>And when they were come out of the ship, straightway they knew him,</i></p> <p>55 <i>And ran through that whole region round about, and began to carry about in beds those that were sick, where they heard he was.</i></p> <p>56 <i>And whithersoever he entered, into villages, or cities, or country, they laid the sick in the streets, and besought him that they might touch if it were but the border of his garment: and as many as touched him were made whole.</i></p> | <p>They all saw Him and were terrified. But immediately He spoke to them and said, "Take courage. It is I. Don't be afraid."</p> <p>He climbed into the boat with them, and the wind died down. They were completely astonished.</p> <p>They had not understood about the loaves. Their hearts were hardened.</p> <p>When they had crossed over, they landed at Gennesaret and anchored there.</p> <p>As soon as they got out of the boat, people recognized Jesus.</p> <p>They ran throughout the whole region and began to bring the sick on mats to wherever they heard He was.</p> <p>Wherever He went — into villages, towns, or countryside — they laid the sick in the marketplaces. They begged Him to let them touch even the edge of His garment. All who touched it were healed.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Herod (*HEHR-od*) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 4:16-30; Matt 13:54-58; Matt 2:23
- v3 — Matt 12:46; Matt 13:55-57; John 6:42; Matt 11:6; Jude 1:1
- v4 — John 4:44; Luke 4:24; Matt 13:57; Jer 12:6
- v7 — Eccl 4:9-10; Matt 10:1-5; Luke 10:17-20; Luke 9:1-6
- v11 — Matt 10:14-15; Acts 18:6; Luke 10:10-15; Neh 5:13; Jude 1:7
- v12 — Matt 4:17; Luke 13:3; Acts 20:21; Luke 24:47; Acts 2:38
- v23 — Esth 7:2; Esth 5:3; Matt 4:9; Esth 5:6; 1 Sam 28:10
- v31 — Mark 3:20; John 6:1; Mark 3:7; Mark 1:45; Matt 14:13
- v34 — Matt 9:36; Luke 9:11; Num 27:17; 2 Chr 18:16; Heb 4:15
- v37 — 2 Kgs 4:42-44; Mark 8:2-3; Num 11:13; Matt 15:32-33; Luke 9:13
- v41 — Matt 14:19; Mark 7:34; Luke 24:30; Luke 9:16; Mark 14:22
- v50 — Matt 14:27; Isa 43:2; John 6:19-20

Chapter 7

Jesus rebukes the Pharisees for holding to human traditions while neglecting the commandments of God. He teaches that defilement comes from the heart, not from unwashed hands, then heals the daughter of a Syrophenician woman and a deaf man with a speech impediment.

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| 1 | <i>Then came together unto him the Pharisees, and certain of the scribes, which came from Jerusalem.</i> | The Pharisees and some of the scribes who had come from Jerusalem gathered around Jesus. |
| 2 | <i>And when they saw some of his disciples eat bread with defiled, that is to say, with unwashen, hands, they found fault.</i> | They saw some of His disciples eating bread with hands that were defiled — that is, unwashed. They found fault with this. |
| 3 | <i>For the Pharisees, and all the Jews, except they wash their hands oft, eat not, holding the tradition of the elders.</i> | The Pharisees and all the Jews do not eat unless they wash their hands carefully, holding to the tradition of the elders. |

- 4 *And when they come from the market, except they wash, they eat not. And many other things there be, which they have received to hold, as the washing of cups, and pots, brassen vessels, and of tables.* When they come from the marketplace they do not eat unless they wash. They also observe many other traditions, such as the washing of cups, pitchers, copper vessels, and dining couches.
- 5 *Then the Pharisees and scribes asked him, Why walk not thy disciples according to the tradition of the elders, but eat bread with unwashen hands?* The Pharisees and scribes asked Him, "Why do Your disciples not live according to the tradition of the elders? Why do they eat with unwashed hands?"
- 6 *He answered and said unto them, Well hath Esaias prophesied of you hypocrites, as it is written, This people honoureth me with their lips, but their heart is far from me.* He answered them, "Isaiah prophesied rightly about you hypocrites, as it is written: 'This people honors Me with their lips, but their heart is far from Me.'"
- 7 *Howbeit in vain do they worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.* "'Their worship of Me is worthless. They teach as doctrines the commandments of men.'"
- 8 *For laying aside the commandment of God, ye hold the tradition of men, as the washing of pots and cups: and many other such like things ye do.* You have set aside the commandment of God to hold to the tradition of men, such as the washing of pots and cups — and You do many other like things."
- 9 *And he said unto them, Full well ye reject the commandment of God, that ye may keep your own tradition.* He also said to them, "You skillfully set aside God's commandment in order to keep Your own tradition."
- 10 *For Moses said, Honour thy father and thy mother; and, Whoso curseth father or mother, let him die the death:* For Moses said, 'Honor your father and your mother,' and, 'Whoever curses father or mother must be put to death.'

- 11 *But ye say, If a man shall say to his father or mother, It is Corban, that is to say, a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me; he shall be free.* But you say that if a man tells his father or mother, 'Whatever help you might have received from me is Corban' — that is, a gift devoted to God — He is no longer required to do anything for His father or mother.
- 12 *And ye suffer him no more to do ought for his father or his mother;* That way you let him do nothing more for his father or mother.
- 13 *Making the word of God of none effect through your tradition, which ye have delivered: and many such like things do ye.* So you nullify the word of God by your tradition that you have handed down. You do many things like that.
- 14 *And when he had called all the people unto him, he said unto them, Hearken unto me every one of you, and understand:* He called the crowd to Him again and said, "Listen to Me, all of you, and understand."
- 15 *There is nothing from without a man, that entering into him can defile him: but the things which come out of him, those are they that defile the man.* Nothing that goes into a man from outside can defile him. It is the things that come out of a man that defile him.
- 16 *If any man have ears to hear, let him hear.* If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear.
- 17 *And when he was entered into the house from the people, his disciples asked him concerning the parable.* When He had left the crowd and entered the house, His disciples asked Him about the parable.
- 18 *And he saith unto them, Are ye so without understanding also? Do ye not perceive, that whatsoever thing from without entereth into the man, it cannot defile him;* He said to them, "Are you also without understanding? Don't you see that nothing that enters a man from outside can defile him?"
- 19 *Because it entereth not into his heart, but into the belly, and goeth out into the draught, purging all meats?* "It does not enter his heart but his stomach, and then is expelled, purging all foods."

- 20 *And he said, That which cometh out of the man, that defileth the man.* He said, "What comes out of a man — that is what defiles him."
- 21 *For from within, out of the heart of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, fornications, murders,* For from within, out of men's hearts, come evil thoughts, adulteries, fornications, murders,
- 22 *Thefts, covetousness, wickedness, deceit, lasciviousness, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, foolishness:* thefts, covetousness, wickedness, deceit, lasciviousness, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, foolishness.
- 23 *All these evil things come from within, and defile the man.* All these evil things come from inside a man and defile him.
- 24 *And from thence he arose, and went into the borders of Tyre and Sidon, and entered into an house, and would have no man know it: but he could not be hid.* Jesus left there and went to the region of Tyre and Sidon. He entered a house and wanted no one to know he was there, but he could not stay hidden.
- 25 *For a certain woman, whose young daughter had an unclean spirit, heard of him, and came and fell at his feet:* A woman whose little daughter had an unclean spirit heard about Him. She came and fell at His feet.
- 26 *The woman was a Greek, a Syrophenician by nation; and she besought him that he would cast forth the devil out of her daughter.* The woman was a Greek, a Syrophenician by birth. She begged Him to drive the demon out of her daughter.
- 27 *But Jesus said unto her, Let the children first be filled: for it is not meet to take the children's bread, and to cast it unto the dogs.* Jesus said to her, "Let the children be satisfied first. It is not right to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs."
- 28 *And she answered and said unto him, Yes, Lord: yet the dogs under the table eat of the children's crumbs.* She answered, "Yes, Lord, but even the dogs under the table eat the children's crumbs."
- 29 *And he said unto her, For this saying go thy way; the devil is gone out of thy daughter.* Then He told her, "Because of what You have said, go. The demon has left Your daughter."

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| <p>30 <i>And when she was come to her house, she found the devil gone out, and her daughter laid upon the bed.</i></p> <p>31 <i>And again, departing from the coasts of Tyre and Sidon, he came unto the sea of Galilee, through the midst of the coasts of Decapolis.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And they bring unto him one that was deaf, and had an impediment in his speech; and they beseech him to put his hand upon him.</i></p> <p>33 <i>And he took him aside from the multitude, and put his fingers into his ears, and he spit, and touched his tongue;</i></p> <p>34 <i>And looking up to heaven, he sighed, and saith unto him, Ephphatha, that is, Be opened.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And straightway his ears were opened, and the string of his tongue was loosed, and he spake plain.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And he charged them that they should tell no man: but the more he charged them, so much the more a great deal they published it;</i></p> <p>37 <i>And were beyond measure astonished, saying, He hath done all things well: he maketh both the deaf to hear, and the dumb to speak.</i></p> | <p>She went home and found her child lying on the bed — the demon was gone.</p> <p>Then Jesus departed from the region of Tyre and Sidon and came to the Sea of Galilee, through the region of Decapolis.</p> <p>There they brought to Him a man who was deaf and could barely speak. They begged Jesus to place His hand on Him.</p> <p>Jesus took Him aside from the crowd, put His fingers into His ears, and touched His tongue with saliva.</p> <p>Looking up to heaven, He sighed and said to the man, "Ephphatha," which means, "Be opened."</p> <p>At once the man's ears were opened, his tongue was freed, and he began to speak clearly.</p> <p>Jesus commanded them not to tell anyone. But the more he commanded them, the more they spread the news.</p> <p>People were completely astonished and said, "He has done everything well. He even makes the deaf hear and the mute speak."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Ephphatha (*EF-ah-thah*) — Aramaic word Jesus spoke meaning 'Be opened' — said when He healed a deaf man.

corban (*KOR-ban*) — A Hebrew term meaning 'gift dedicated to God' — in Mark 7, Jesus rebukes those who used it to avoid caring for their parents.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v6 — Isa 29:13; Titus 1:16; Matt 15:7-9; Ezek 33:31; 2 Tim 3:5
- v7 — Isa 29:13; Matt 15:9; Col 2:22; Jas 1:26; Matt 6:7
- v9 — Isa 29:13; Jer 44:16-17; Gal 2:21; Isa 24:5; Matt 15:3-6
- v10 — Ex 21:17; Ex 20:12; Deut 5:16; Lev 20:9; Matt 15:4
- v13 — Mark 7:9; Titus 1:14; Matt 5:17-20; Isa 8:20; Matt 15:6
- v15 — Prov 4:23; Lev 11:42-47; Titus 1:15; Heb 13:9; Matt 12:34
- v20 — Jas 3:6; Jas 1:14-15; Jas 4:1; Mark 7:15; Matt 12:34-37
- v21 — Jer 17:9; Jas 4:1-3; Rom 8:7-8; Matt 15:19; Gal 5:19-21
- v24 — Matt 15:21-28; Matt 11:21; Ezek 28:2; Mark 6:31-32; Mark 3:7-8
- v27 — Matt 15:23-28; Matt 7:6; Matt 10:5; Acts 22:21; Eph 2:12
- v28 — Rom 10:12; Rom 3:29; Acts 11:17-18; Luke 15:30-32; Isa 45:22
- v37 — Mark 6:51; Mark 5:42; Mark 4:41; Ex 4:10-11; Mark 2:12

Chapter 8

Jesus feeds four thousand people with seven loaves, refuses the Pharisees' demand for a sign, and heals a blind man at Bethsaida. Peter confesses that Jesus is the Christ, and Jesus foretells His suffering, death, and resurrection, calling on His followers to take up their cross.

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| 1 | <i>In those days the multitude being very great, and having nothing to eat, Jesus called his disciples unto him, and saith unto them,</i> | In those days, when there was again a large crowd with nothing to eat, Jesus called His disciples and said to them, |
| 2 | <i>I have compassion on the multitude, because they have now been with me three days, and have nothing to eat:</i> | "I have compassion on this crowd because they have been with Me three days and have nothing to eat." |
| 3 | <i>And if I send them away fasting to their own houses, they will faint by the way: for divers of them came from far.</i> | "If I send them home hungry, they will faint on the way. Some of them have come from a great distance." |
| 4 | <i>And his disciples answered him, From whence can a man satisfy these men with bread here in the wilderness?</i> | His disciples answered, "From where could anyone get enough bread to feed these people here in the wilderness?" |
| 5 | <i>And he asked them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven.</i> | He asked them, "How many loaves do You have?" "Seven," they said. |

- 6 *And he commanded the people to sit down on the ground: and he took the seven loaves, and gave thanks, and brake, and gave to his disciples to set before them; and they did set them before the people.* He directed the crowd to sit down on the ground. Taking the seven loaves, He gave thanks, broke them, and gave them to His disciples to distribute. They set them before the crowd.
- 7 *And they had a few small fishes: and he blessed, and commanded to set them also before them.* They also had a few small fish. He gave thanks for these and told the disciples to distribute them as well.
- 8 *So they did eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets.* The people ate and were satisfied. Afterward the disciples picked up seven basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.
- 9 *And they that had eaten were about four thousand: and he sent them away.* About four thousand people had eaten. He sent them away.
- 10 *And straightway he entered into a ship with his disciples, and came into the parts of Dalmanutha.* He got into the boat with His disciples at once and went to the region of Dalmanutha.
- 11 *And the Pharisees came forth, and began to question with him, seeking of him a sign from heaven, tempting him.* The Pharisees came out and began to question Him. To test Him, they demanded a sign from heaven.
- 12 *And he sighed deeply in his spirit, and saith, Why doth this generation seek after a sign? verily I say unto you, There shall no sign be given unto this generation.* He sighed deeply in His spirit and said, "Why does this generation ask for a sign? Truly I tell You, no sign will be given to this generation."
- 13 *And he left them, and entering into the ship again departed to the other side.* He left them and got back into the boat and crossed to the other side.
- 14 *Now the disciples had forgotten to take bread, neither had they in the ship with them more than one loaf.* The disciples had forgotten to bring bread. They had only one loaf with them in the boat.

- 15 *And he charged them, saying, Take heed, beware of the leaven of the Pharisees, and of the leaven of Herod.* Jesus warned them, "Watch out — beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and the leaven of Herod."
- 16 *And they reasoned among themselves, saying, It is because we have no bread.* They discussed this among themselves: "He said this because we have no bread."
- 17 *And when Jesus knew it, he saith unto them, Why reason ye, because ye have no bread? perceive ye not yet, neither understand? have ye your heart yet hardened?* Jesus knew what they were saying. He said, "Why are You talking about having no bread? Don't You yet see or understand? Is Your heart still hardened?"
- 18 *Having eyes, see ye not? and having ears, hear ye not? and do ye not remember?* "Do You have eyes and fail to see? Do You have ears and fail to hear? Don't You remember?"
- 19 *When I brake the five loaves among five thousand, how many baskets full of fragments took ye up? They say unto him, Twelve.* "When I broke the five loaves for the five thousand, how many basketfuls of pieces did You pick up?" "Twelve," they said.
- 20 *And when the seven among four thousand, how many baskets full of fragments took ye up? And they said, Seven.* "And when the seven loaves fed the four thousand, how many basketfuls did You pick up?" "Seven," they said.
- 21 *And he said unto them, How is it that ye do not understand?* He said to them, "Do You still not understand?"
- 22 *And he cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him, and besought him to touch him.* They came to Bethsaida. Some people brought a blind man to Jesus and begged Him to touch Him.
- 23 *And he took the blind man by the hand, and led him out of the town; and when he had spit on his eyes, and put his hands upon him, he asked him if he saw ought.* He took the blind man by the hand and led him outside the village. He spit on the man's eyes and put his hands on him. He asked, "Do you see anything?"

- 24 *And he looked up, and said, I see men as trees, walking.* He looked up and said, "I see people — they look like trees walking around."
- 25 *After that he put his hands again upon his eyes, and made him look up: and he was restored, and saw every man clearly.* Jesus put His hands on the man's eyes again. He opened his eyes, and his sight was restored — he saw everything clearly.
- 26 *And he sent him away to his house, saying, Neither go into the town, nor tell it to any in the town.* Jesus sent Him home, saying, "Don't go into the village or tell anyone in the village."
- 27 *And Jesus went out, and his disciples, into the towns of Caesarea Philippi: and by the way he asked his disciples, saying unto them, Whom do men say that I am?* Jesus and His disciples went out to the villages around Caesarea Philippi. On the way He asked His disciples, "Who do people say I am?"
- 28 *And they answered, John the Baptist: but some say, Elias; and others, One of the prophets.* They replied, "Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others, one of the prophets."
- 29 *And he saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am? And Peter answereth and saith unto him, Thou art the Christ.* "But who do You say I am?" He asked. Peter answered, "You are the Christ."
- 30 *And he charged them that they should tell no man of him.* He warned them not to tell anyone about him.
- 31 *And he began to teach them, that the Son of man must suffer many things, and be rejected of the elders, and of the chief priests, and scribes, and be killed, and after three days rise again.* He began to teach them that the Son of Man must suffer many things. He would be rejected by the elders, the chief priests, and the scribes. He would be killed, and after three days He would rise again.
- 32 *And he spake that saying openly. And Peter took him, and began to rebuke him.* He spoke plainly about this. Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him.

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| <p>33 <i>But when he had turned about and looked on his disciples, he rebuked Peter, saying, Get thee behind me, Satan: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but the things that be of men.</i></p> | <p>Jesus turned and looked at His disciples, then rebuked Peter. He said, "Get behind Me, Satan! You do not have in mind the things of God, but the things of men."</p> |
| <p>34 <i>And when he had called the people unto him with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.</i></p> | <p>He called the crowd to Him along with His disciples and said, "Whoever wants to come after Me must deny himself, take up His cross, and follow Me."</p> |
| <p>35 <i>For whosoever will save his life shall lose it; but whosoever shall lose his life for my sake and the gospel's, the same shall save it.</i></p> | <p>Whoever wants to save his life will lose it. But whoever loses his life for My sake and the gospel's will save it.</p> |
| <p>36 <i>For what shall it profit a man, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul?</i></p> | <p>What does it profit a man to gain the whole world yet forfeit his soul?</p> |
| <p>37 <i>Or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?</i></p> | <p>What can a man give in exchange for his soul?</p> |
| <p>38 <i>Whosoever therefore shall be ashamed of me and of my words in this adulterous and sinful generation; of him also shall the Son of man be ashamed, when he cometh in the glory of his Father with the holy angels.</i></p> | <p>Whoever is ashamed of Me and My words in this adulterous and sinful generation — the Son of Man will be ashamed of Him when He comes in His Father's glory with the holy angels.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Herod (*HEHR-od*) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Col 3:17; Matt 14:18-19; Matt 15:35-36; John 6:10-11; 1 Cor 10:30-31
- v11 — Matt 12:38; 1 Cor 10:9; John 4:48; Mal 3:15; Luke 12:54-57
- v12 — Matt 12:39-40; Mark 7:34; John 12:37-43; Matt 16:4; Luke 11:29-30
- v15 — 1 Cor 5:6-8; Matt 16:6; Mark 12:13; Matt 16:11-12; Luke 12:1-2
- v18 — Acts 28:26-27; Matt 13:14-15; Jer 5:21; Mark 4:12; Ezek 12:2
- v22 — Matt 11:21; Mark 6:45; Luke 10:13; Mark 2:3; John 1:44
- v29 — 1 John 4:15; Matt 16:15-16; 1 John 5:1; John 11:27; Luke 9:20
- v31 — Mark 10:33-34; John 2:19; Luke 24:26; Mark 9:31-32; Luke 17:25
- v34 — Matt 10:38; Luke 14:26-27; John 10:27; 1 Kgs 14:8; Gal 5:24
- v35 — 2 Tim 2:11-13; 1 Cor 9:23; Luke 17:33; Matt 16:25; 2 Tim 1:8
- v36 — Matt 16:26; Luke 9:25; Ps 49:17; Jas 1:9-11; Phil 3:7-9
- v38 — Luke 12:8-9; Rom 1:16; 1 John 2:23; Jas 4:4; Matt 10:32-33

Chapter 9

Jesus is transfigured before Peter, James, and John on a high mountain, and Moses and Elijah appear with Him. He casts out a demon the disciples could not, foretells His death and resurrection a second time, and teaches that whoever would be greatest must be servant of all.

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| 1 | <i>And he said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That there be some of them that stand here, which shall not taste of death, till they have seen the kingdom of God come with power.</i> | He said to them, "Truly I tell You, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God come with power." |
| 2 | <i>And after six days Jesus taketh with him Peter, and James, and John, and leadeth them up into an high mountain apart by themselves: and he was transfigured before them.</i> | After six days Jesus took Peter, James, and John with him. He led them up a high mountain alone by themselves. He was transfigured before them. |
| 3 | <i>And his raiment became shining, exceeding white as snow; so as no fuller on earth can white them.</i> | His clothes became dazzling white — whiter than anyone in the world could bleach them. |

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| 4 | <i>And there appeared unto them Elias with Moses: and they were talking with Jesus.</i> | Elijah appeared to them with Moses, and they were talking with Jesus. |
| 5 | <i>And Peter answered and said to Jesus, Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias.</i> | Peter said to Jesus, "Rabbi, it is good for us to be here. Let us put up three shelters — one for You, one for Moses, and one for Elijah." |
| 6 | <i>For he wist not what to say; for they were sore afraid.</i> | He did not know what to say, for they were terrified. |
| 7 | <i>And there was a cloud that overshadowed them: and a voice came out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him.</i> | Then a cloud came and covered them, and a voice came from the cloud: "This is My beloved Son. Listen to Him." |
| 8 | <i>And suddenly, when they had looked round about, they saw no man any more, save Jesus only with themselves.</i> | Suddenly, when they looked around, they saw no one with them anymore except Jesus. |
| 9 | <i>And as they came down from the mountain, he charged them that they should tell no man what things they had seen, till the Son of man were risen from the dead.</i> | As they came down the mountain, He commanded them to tell no one what they had seen until the Son of Man had risen from the dead. |
| 10 | <i>And they kept that saying with themselves, questioning one with another what the rising from the dead should mean.</i> | They kept the matter to themselves, asking each other what "rising from the dead" meant. |
| 11 | <i>And they asked him, saying, Why say the scribes that Elias must first come?</i> | They asked Him, "Why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?" |
| 12 | <i>And he answered and told them, Elias verily cometh first, and restoreth all things; and how it is written of the Son of man, that he must suffer many things, and be set at nought.</i> | He said to them, "Elijah does come first and restores all things. But how is it written of the Son of Man that He must suffer many things and be treated with contempt?" |

- 13 *But I say unto you, That Elias is indeed come, and they have done unto him whatsoever they listed, as it is written of him.* "Truly I tell you, Elijah has already come, and they did to him whatever they pleased, just as it is written about him."
- 14 *And when he came to his disciples, he saw a great multitude about them, and the scribes questioning with them.* When they came to the other disciples, they saw a large crowd around them and the scribes arguing with them.
- 15 *And straightway all the people, when they beheld him, were greatly amazed, and running to him saluted him.* As soon as the crowd saw Jesus, they were greatly amazed and ran to greet Him.
- 16 *And he asked the scribes, What question ye with them?* He asked the scribes, "What are You arguing with them about?"
- 17 *And one of the multitude answered and said, Master, I have brought unto thee my son, which hath a dumb spirit;* A man in the crowd answered, "Master, I brought you my son, who has a spirit that makes Him mute."
- 18 *And wheresoever he taketh him, he teareth him: and he foameth, and gnasheth with his teeth, and pineth away: and I spake to thy disciples that they should cast him out; and they could not.* "Wherever it takes hold of Him, it throws Him down. He foams at the mouth, gnashes His teeth, and becomes rigid. I asked Your disciples to drive it out, but they could not."
- 19 *He answereth him, and saith, O faithless generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him unto me.* He answered, "O faithless generation, how long shall I be with You? How long shall I put up with You? Bring the boy to Me."
- 20 *And they brought him unto him: and when he saw him, straightway the spirit tare him; and he fell on the ground, and wallowed foaming.* They brought the boy to him. When the spirit saw Jesus, it immediately threw the boy into a convulsion. He fell to the ground and rolled around, foaming at the mouth.
- 21 *And he asked his father, How long is it ago since this came unto him? And he said, Of a child.* Jesus asked His father, "How long has this been happening to Him?" "From childhood," He said.

- 22 *And oftentimes it hath cast him into the fire, and into the waters, to destroy him: but if thou canst do any thing, have compassion on us, and help us.* "It has often thrown Him into fire and into water to kill Him. But if You can do anything, have compassion on us and help us."
- 23 *Jesus said unto him, If thou canst believe, all things are possible to him that believeth.* Jesus said to Him, "If You can believe — all things are possible to the one who believes."
- 24 *And straightway the father of the child cried out, and said with tears, Lord, I believe; help thou mine unbelief.* The father of the child cried out at once, "Lord, I believe — help my unbelief!"
- 25 *When Jesus saw that the people came running together, he rebuked the foul spirit, saying unto him, Thou dumb and deaf spirit, I charge thee, come out of him, and enter no more into him.* When Jesus saw that the crowd was running to see what was happening, He rebuked the unclean spirit. He said, "You mute and deaf spirit, I command You — come out of Him and never enter Him again."
- 26 *And the spirit cried, and rent him sore, and came out of him: and he was as one dead; insomuch that many said, He is dead.* The spirit cried out, convulsed the boy violently, and came out. The boy looked so much like a corpse that many said, "He is dead."
- 27 *But Jesus took him by the hand, and lifted him up; and he arose.* But Jesus took Him by the hand and lifted Him up, and He stood up.
- 28 *And when he was come into the house, his disciples asked him privately, Why could not we cast him out?* After Jesus went indoors, His disciples asked Him privately, "Why could we not drive it out?"
- 29 *And he said unto them, This kind can come forth by nothing, but by prayer and fasting.* He said to them, "This kind can come out by nothing except prayer and fasting."
- 30 *And they departed thence, and passed through Galilee; and he would not that any man should know it.* They left that place and passed through Galilee. He did not want anyone to know where they were.

- 31 *For he taught his disciples, and said unto them, The Son of man is delivered into the hands of men, and they shall kill him; and after that he is killed, he shall rise the third day.* He was teaching His disciples, telling them, "The Son of Man is going to be delivered into the hands of men. They will kill Him, and after three days He will rise."
- 32 *But they understood not that saying, and were afraid to ask him.* They did not understand what He meant and were afraid to ask Him about it.
- 33 *And he came to Capernaum: and being in the house he asked them, What was it that ye disputed among yourselves by the way?* They came to Capernaum. When He was in the house, He asked them, "What were You arguing about on the road?"
- 34 *But they held their peace: for by the way they had disputed among themselves, who should be the greatest.* They were silent, because on the road they had argued about who was the greatest.
- 35 *And he sat down, and called the twelve, and saith unto them, If any man desire to be first, the same shall be last of all, and servant of all.* He sat down, called the twelve, and said to them, "If anyone wants to be first, he must be last of all and servant of all."
- 36 *And he took a child, and set him in the midst of them: and when he had taken him in his arms, he said unto them,* He took a little child and set Him in the middle of them. Taking the child in his arms, he said to them,
- 37 *Whosoever shall receive one of such children in my name, receiveth me: and whosoever shall receive me, receiveth not me, but him that sent me.* "Whoever receives one of these little children in My name receives Me. Whoever receives Me receives not Me but the One who sent Me."
- 38 *And John answered him, saying, Master, we saw one casting out devils in thy name, and he followeth not us: and we forbad him, because he followeth not us.* John said to him, "Master, we saw someone casting out demons in your name and we told Him to stop, because He was not one of us."

- 39 *But Jesus said, Forbid him not: for there is no man which shall do a miracle in my name, that can lightly speak evil of me.* Jesus said, "Do not stop Him. No one who does a miracle in My name can soon speak evil of Me."
- 40 *For he that is not against us is on our part.* Whoever is not against us is for us.
- 41 *For whosoever shall give you a cup of water to drink in my name, because ye belong to Christ, truly I say unto you, he shall not lose his reward.* Truly I tell You, whoever gives you a cup of water to drink because you belong to Christ will certainly not lose His reward.
- 42 *And whosoever shall offend one of these little ones that believe in me, it is better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea.* If anyone causes one of these little ones who believe in Me to sin, it would be better for Him to have a large millstone hung around His neck and to be thrown into the sea.
- 43 *And if thy hand offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter into life maimed, than having two hands to go into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched:* If Your hand causes You to sin, cut it off. It is better to enter life maimed than to go into hell with two hands — into the fire that never goes out.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Hell* (HEL) — the place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one English word — "hell" — where the Greek uses three different words (Sheol, Hades, and Gehenna). All three refer to the place of the departed or the place of final punishment. Hell is real, it is terrible, and it is forever.

- 44 *Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.* where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.
- 45 *And if thy foot offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter halt into life, than having two feet to be cast into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched:* If Your foot causes You to sin, cut it off. It is better to enter life lame than to be thrown into hell with two feet — into the fire that never goes out.
- 46 *Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.* where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.

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| 47 | <i>And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out: it is better for thee to enter into the kingdom of God with one eye, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire:</i> | If Your eye causes You to sin, pluck it out. It is better to enter the kingdom of God with one eye than to be thrown into hell with two eyes, |
| 48 | <i>Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.</i> | where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched. |
| 49 | <i>For every one shall be salted with fire, and every sacrifice shall be salted with salt.</i> | Everyone will be salted with fire, and every sacrifice will be salted with salt. |
| 50 | <i>Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his saltness, wherewith will ye season it? Have salt in yourselves, and have peace one with another.</i> | Salt is good, but if it loses its saltiness, how can You make it salty again? Have salt in yourselves and be at peace with one another. |

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 9:27; Heb 2:9; Mark 13:30; Matt 16:28; Luke 2:26
v2 — Luke 9:28-36; Matt 17:1-8; Isa 33:17; Mark 5:37; Mark 14:33
v7 — 2 Pet 1:17; Matt 3:17; Luke 9:34-36; Mark 1:11; Heb 2:1
v12 — Isa 53:1-12; Isa 50:6; Isa 52:14; Isa 40:3-5; Luke 1:16-17
v23 — John 11:40; Heb 11:6; Mark 11:23; Matt 17:20; Matt 21:21-22
v24 — Luke 17:5; Heb 12:2; Eph 2:8; 2 Thess 1:11; 2 Thess 1:3
v29 — Jas 5:15; Dan 9:3; Matt 17:20; Eph 6:18; 2 Cor 12:8
v35 — Matt 20:25-28; Luke 22:26; Mark 10:42-45; Luke 14:10-11; Matt 23:11
v37 — Matt 18:3-5; Luke 10:16; Matt 10:40-42; John 12:44-45; John 14:21-23
v38 — Luke 9:49-50; Num 11:26-29; Luke 11:19
v43 — Matt 5:29-30; Matt 18:8-9; Matt 25:41; Heb 12:1; Matt 5:22
v50 — Col 4:6; Rom 12:18; Matt 5:13; Heb 12:14; 2 Cor 13:11

Chapter 10

Jesus teaches on divorce and blesses little children brought to Him. A rich young ruler refuses to sell all and follow Him, and Jesus tells His disciples that with God all things are possible. He foretells His death a third time, rebukes the ambition of James and John, and heals blind Bartimaeus near Jericho.

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| 1 | <i>And he arose from thence, and cometh into the coasts of Judaea by the farther side of Jordan: and the people resort unto him again; and, as he was wont, he taught them again.</i> | Jesus left there and went into the region of Judaea and beyond the Jordan. Crowds gathered around Him again, and as was His custom, He taught them. |
| 2 | <i>And the Pharisees came to him, and asked him, Is it lawful for a man to put away his wife? tempting him.</i> | Some Pharisees came to Him and asked, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife?" They were testing him. |
| 3 | <i>And he answered and said unto them, What did Moses command you?</i> | He answered them, "What did Moses command you?" |
| 4 | <i>And they said, Moses suffered to write a bill of divorcement, and to put her away.</i> | They said, "Moses permitted a man to write a certificate of divorce and send her away." |
| 5 | <i>And Jesus answered and said unto them, For the hardness of your heart he wrote you this precept.</i> | Jesus said to them, "Moses wrote this commandment for you because of the hardness of Your hearts." |
| 6 | <i>But from the beginning of the creation God made them male and female.</i> | But from the beginning of creation God made them male and female. |
| 7 | <i>For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and cleave to his wife;</i> | For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and hold fast to his wife, |
| 8 | <i>And they twain shall be one flesh: so then they are no more twain, but one flesh.</i> | and the two shall become one flesh. So they are no longer two but one flesh. |
| 9 | <i>What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.</i> | What therefore God has joined together, let no man separate. |
| 10 | <i>And in the house his disciples asked him again of the same matter.</i> | In the house His disciples asked Him again about this. |
| 11 | <i>And he saith unto them, Whosoever shall put away his wife, and marry another, committeth adultery against her.</i> | He said to them, "Whoever divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery against her." |

- 12 *And if a woman shall put away her husband, and be married to another, she committeth adultery.* And if she divorces her husband and marries another, she commits adultery.
- 13 *And they brought young children to him, that he should touch them: and his disciples rebuked those that brought them.* People were bringing little children to Jesus for Him to touch them. The disciples rebuked those who brought them.
- 14 *But when Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them, Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.* When Jesus saw this, He was indignant. He said to them, "Let the little children come to Me. Do not stop them, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as these."
- 15 *Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein.* Truly I tell You, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God like a little child will never enter it.
- 16 *And he took them up in his arms, put his hands upon them, and blessed them.* He took the children in His arms, placed His hands on them, and blessed them.
- 17 *And when he was gone forth into the way, there came one running, and kneeled to him, and asked him, Good Master, what shall I do that I may inherit eternal life?* As He was going out on the road, a man ran up and knelt before him. He asked, "Good Master, what must I do to inherit eternal life?"
- 18 *And Jesus said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God.* Jesus said to Him, "Why do You call Me good? No one is good except God alone."
- 19 *Thou knowest the commandments, Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Defraud not, Honour thy father and mother.* You know the commandments: Do not commit adultery, do not murder, do not steal, do not give false testimony, do not defraud, honor Your father and mother.
- 20 *And he answered and said unto him, Master, all these have I observed from my youth.* The man replied, "Master, all these I have kept since I was young."

- 21 *Then Jesus beholding him loved him, and said unto him, One thing thou lackest: go thy way, sell whatsoever thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come, take up the cross, and follow me.* Jesus looked at Him and loved Him. He said, "One thing You lack. Go, sell everything You have and give to the poor, and You will have treasure in heaven. Then come, take up Your cross, and follow Me."
- 22 *And he was sad at that saying, and went away grieved: for he had great possessions.* The man's face fell at these words. He went away sad, because he had great wealth.
- 23 *And Jesus looked round about, and saith unto his disciples, How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God!* Jesus looked around and said to His disciples, "How hard it is for those who have riches to enter the kingdom of God!"
- 24 *And the disciples were astonished at his words. But Jesus answereth again, and saith unto them, Children, how hard is it for them that trust in riches to enter into the kingdom of God!* The disciples were amazed at His words. Jesus said again, "Children, how hard it is for those who trust in riches to enter the kingdom of God!"
- 25 *It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.* It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God.
- 26 *And they were astonished out of measure, saying among themselves, Who then can be saved?* They were even more amazed and said to one another, "Who then can be saved?"
- 27 *And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.* Jesus looked at them and said, "With men it is impossible, but not with God. All things are possible with God."
- 28 *Then Peter began to say unto him, Lo, we have left all, and have followed thee.* Peter said to him, "We have left everything to follow You."

- 29 *And Jesus answered and said, Verily I say unto you, There is no man that hath left house, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my sake, and the gospel's,* Truly I tell You, Jesus answered, there is no one who has left house, brothers, sisters, father, mother, wife, children, or lands for My sake and for the gospel's sake,
- 30 *But he shall receive an hundredfold now in this time, houses, and brethren, and sisters, and mothers, and children, and lands, with persecutions; and in the world to come eternal life.* who will not receive a hundred times as much in this present age — houses, brothers, sisters, mothers, children, and lands, along with persecutions — and in the age to come, eternal life.
- 31 *But many that are first shall be last; and the last first.* But many who are first will be last, and the last first.
- 32 *And they were in the way going up to Jerusalem; and Jesus went before them: and they were amazed; and as they followed, they were afraid. And he took again the twelve, and began to tell them what things should happen unto him,* They were on the road going up to Jerusalem. Jesus walked ahead of them. The disciples were amazed and those following were afraid. He took the twelve aside again and began to tell them what was going to happen to Him.
- 33 *Saying, Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be delivered unto the chief priests, and unto the scribes; and they shall condemn him to death, and shall deliver him to the Gentiles:* "We are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be delivered to the chief priests and the scribes. They will condemn Him to death and hand Him over to the Gentiles."
- 34 *And they shall mock him, and shall scourge him, and shall spit upon him, and shall kill him: and the third day he shall rise again.* "They will mock Him, spit on Him, flog Him, and kill Him. After three days He will rise again."
- 35 *And James and John, the sons of Zebedee, come unto him, saying, Master, we would that thou shouldest do for us whatsoever we shall desire.* James and John, the sons of Zebedee, came to him. "Master," they said, "we want You to do whatever we ask."

- 36 *And he said unto them, What would ye that I should do for you?* He said to them, "What do You want Me to do for You?"
- 37 *They said unto him, Grant unto us that we may sit, one on thy right hand, and the other on thy left hand, in thy glory.* They said, "Grant us to sit, one on Your right and one on Your left, in Your glory."
- 38 *But Jesus said unto them, Ye know not what ye ask: can ye drink of the cup that I drink of? and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?* Jesus said to them, "You do not know what You are asking. Can You drink the cup I drink or be baptized with the baptism I am baptized with?"
- 39 *And they said unto him, We can. And Jesus said unto them, Ye shall indeed drink of the cup that I drink of; and with the baptism that I am baptized withal shall ye be baptized:* "We can," they answered. Jesus said to them, "You will drink the cup I drink and You will be baptized with the baptism I am baptized with."
- 40 *But to sit on my right hand and on my left hand is not mine to give; but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared.* "But to sit on My right or left is not Mine to give. It belongs to those for whom it has been prepared."
- 41 *And when the ten heard it, they began to be much displeased with James and John.* When the other ten heard this, they were indignant at James and John.
- 42 *But Jesus called them to him, and saith unto them, Ye know that they which are accounted to rule over the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and their great ones exercise authority upon them.* Jesus called them together and said, "You know that those who are considered rulers over the Gentiles lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them."
- 43 *But so shall it not be among you: but whosoever will be great among you, shall be your minister:* It shall not be so among You. Whoever wants to be great among you must be your servant.
- 44 *And whosoever of you will be the chiefest, shall be servant of all.* Whoever wants to be first among you must be slave of all.

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| <p>45 <i>For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.</i></p> <p>46 <i>And they came to Jericho: and as he went out of Jericho with his disciples and a great number of people, blind Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, sat by the highway side begging.</i></p> | <p>For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give His life as a ransom for many.</p> <p>They came to Jericho. As Jesus and His disciples were leaving Jericho with a large crowd, blind Bartimaeus the son of Timaeus was sitting by the roadside begging.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Bartimaeus** (bar-tih-MAY-us) — Aramaic, "son of Timaeus" — A blind beggar near Jericho whose persistent cry for mercy led Jesus to restore his sight.

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| <p>47 <i>And when he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to cry out, and say, Jesus, thou Son of David, have mercy on me.</i></p> <p>48 <i>And many charged him that he should hold his peace: but he cried the more a great deal, Thou Son of David, have mercy on me.</i></p> <p>49 <i>And Jesus stood still, and commanded him to be called. And they call the blind man, saying unto him, Be of good comfort, rise; he calleth thee.</i></p> <p>50 <i>And he, casting away his garment, rose, and came to Jesus.</i></p> <p>51 <i>And Jesus answered and said unto him, What wilt thou that I should do unto thee? The blind man said unto him, Lord, that I might receive my sight.</i></p> <p>52 <i>And Jesus said unto him, Go thy way; thy faith hath made thee whole. And immediately he received his sight, and followed Jesus in the way.</i></p> | <p>When He heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, He began to cry out, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!"</p> <p>Many told him to be quiet, but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"</p> <p>Jesus stopped and said, "Call Him." They called the blind man, saying, "Take courage! Get up — He is calling You."</p> <p>He threw off His cloak, jumped up, and came to Jesus.</p> <p>Jesus said to Him, "What do You want Me to do for You?" The blind man said, "Lord, that I might receive my sight."</p> <p>Jesus said to Him, "Go. Your faith has made You well." At once He received His sight and followed Jesus along the road.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Bartimaeus (*bar-tih-MEE-us*) — A blind beggar sitting by the road in Jericho who cried out to Jesus — his persistent faith earned him the healing of his sight; his name means 'son of Timaeus.'

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Nazareth (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Gen 1:27; Gen 5:2; Gen 1:1; Gen 2:20-23; Mal 2:14-16
- v14 — Matt 19:14; Matt 18:4; Matt 18:10; Ps 131:1-2; Luke 18:15-16
- v17 — Matt 19:16-30; Luke 18:18-30; Rom 2:7; John 6:27-28; Luke 10:25
- v18 — Luke 18:19; Matt 19:17; Rom 3:12; 1 Sam 2:2; 1 John 4:16
- v27 — Jer 32:27; Matt 19:26; Job 42:2; Jer 32:17; Gen 18:13-14
- v28 — Matt 19:27-30; Luke 14:33; Luke 18:28-30; Mark 1:16-20; Phil 3:7-9
- v29 — 1 Cor 9:23; Matt 5:10-11; Mark 8:35; Heb 11:24-26; Gen 12:1-3
- v30 — Luke 18:30; Phil 3:8; 2 Cor 6:10; Matt 5:11-12; Jas 1:12
- v43 — Matt 23:8-12; Luke 14:11; Mark 9:35; Matt 20:26-27; Luke 9:48
- v45 — Matt 20:28; Phil 2:5-8; 2 Cor 8:9; Titus 2:14; John 13:14
- v46 — Luke 18:35-19:1; Matt 20:29-34; John 9:8
- v51 — Luke 18:41-43; Matt 7:7; Mark 10:36; 2 Chr 1:7; Phil 4:6

Chapter 11

Jesus enters Jerusalem riding on a colt as the crowds cry 'Hosanna' and spread their garments in the road. He drives out the money changers from the temple, curses a barren fig tree that withers by the next morning, and teaches about faith and prayer.

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| <p>¹ <i>And when they came nigh to Jerusalem, unto Bethphage and Bethany, at the mount of Olives, he sendeth forth two of his disciples,</i></p> | <p>As they approached Jerusalem, near Bethphage and Bethany at the Mount of Olives, He sent out two of His disciples.</p> |
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| 2 <i>And saith unto them, Go your way into the village over against you: and as soon as ye be entered into it, ye shall find a colt tied, whereon never man sat; loose him, and bring him.</i> | He said to them, "Go into the village ahead of You. As soon as You enter it, You will find a colt tied there that no one has ever ridden. Untie it and bring it here." |
| 3 <i>And if any man say unto you, Why do ye this? say ye that the Lord hath need of him; and straightway he will send him hither.</i> | "If anyone asks you, 'Why are you doing this?' say, 'The Lord needs it and will send it back here shortly.'" |
| 4 <i>And they went their way, and found the colt tied by the door without in a place where two ways met; and they loose him.</i> | They went and found the colt tied outside in the street at a doorway. They untied it. |
| 5 <i>And certain of them that stood there said unto them, What do ye, loosing the colt?</i> | Some people standing there asked, "What are You doing, untying that colt?" |
| 6 <i>And they said unto them even as Jesus had commanded: and they let them go.</i> | They answered as Jesus had told them, and the people let them go. |
| 7 <i>And they brought the colt to Jesus, and cast their garments on him; and he sat upon him.</i> | They brought the colt to Jesus and threw their cloaks on it, and He sat on it. |
| 8 <i>And many spread their garments in the way: and others cut down branches off the trees, and strawed them in the way.</i> | Many people spread their cloaks on the road. Others spread branches they had cut from the fields. |
| 9 <i>And they that went before, and they that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna; Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord:</i> | Those who went ahead and those who followed shouted, "Hosanna! Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!" |
| 10 <i>Blessed be the kingdom of our father David, that cometh in the name of the Lord: Hosanna in the highest.</i> | "Blessed is the coming kingdom of our father David! Hosanna in the highest!" |

- 11 *And Jesus entered into Jerusalem, and into the temple: and when he had looked round about upon all things, and now the eventide was come, he went out unto Bethany with the twelve.* Jesus entered Jerusalem and went to the temple. He looked around at everything, but since it was already late, He went out to Bethany with the twelve.
- 12 *And on the morrow, when they were come from Bethany, he was hungry:* The next day, when they came from Bethany, He was hungry.
- 13 *And seeing a fig tree afar off having leaves, he came, if haply he might find any thing thereon: and when he came to it, he found nothing but leaves; for the time of figs was not yet.* Seeing a fig tree in the distance with leaves on it, He went to see if it had any fruit. When He came to it, He found nothing but leaves, because it was not the season for figs.
- 14 *And Jesus answered and said unto it, No man eat fruit of thee hereafter for ever. And his disciples heard it.* Jesus said to it, "May no one ever eat fruit from you again." And his disciples heard this.
- 15 *And they come to Jerusalem: and Jesus went into the temple, and began to cast out them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves;* They came to Jerusalem. Jesus entered the temple and began to drive out those who were buying and selling there. He overturned the tables of the money changers and the benches of those selling doves.
- 16 *And would not suffer that any man should carry any vessel through the temple.* He would not allow anyone to carry goods through the temple courts.
- 17 *And he taught, saying unto them, Is it not written, My house shall be called of all nations the house of prayer? but ye have made it a den of thieves.* He was teaching them and said, "Is it not written: 'My house shall be called a house of prayer for all nations'? But You have made it a den of thieves."
- 18 *And the scribes and chief priests heard it, and sought how they might destroy him: for they feared him, because all the people was astonished at his doctrine.* The chief priests and scribes heard this and began to look for a way to destroy Him. They feared Him, because the whole crowd was astonished at His teaching.

- 19 *And when even was come, he went out of the city.* When evening came, they went out of the city.
- 20 *And in the morning, as they passed by, they saw the fig tree dried up from the roots.* In the morning as they walked along, they saw that the fig tree had withered from its roots.
- 21 *And Peter calling to remembrance saith unto him, Master, behold, the fig tree which thou cursedst is withered away.* Peter remembered and said to him, "Rabbi, look! The fig tree You cursed has withered."
- 22 *And Jesus answering saith unto them, Have faith in God.* Jesus answered, "Have faith in God."
- 23 *For verily I say unto you, That whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart, but shall believe that those things which he saith shall come to pass; he shall have whatsoever he saith.* Truly I tell You, whoever says to this mountain, 'Be lifted up and thrown into the sea,' and does not doubt in His heart but believes that what He says will happen — it will be done for Him.
- 24 *Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.* Therefore I tell You, whatever You ask for in prayer, believe that You have received it, and it will be Yours.
- 25 *And when ye stand praying, forgive, if ye have ought against any: that your Father also which is in heaven may forgive you your trespasses.* When You stand praying, forgive whatever You have against anyone, so that your Father in heaven may also forgive You Your sins.
- 26 *But if ye do not forgive, neither will your Father which is in heaven forgive your trespasses.* But if You do not forgive, neither will Your Father in heaven forgive Your sins.
- 27 *And they come again to Jerusalem: and as he was walking in the temple, there come to him the chief priests, and the scribes, and the elders,* They came again to Jerusalem. While He was walking in the temple, the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders came to Him.

- 28 *And say unto him, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority to do these things?* They asked, "By what authority are You doing these things? Who gave You this authority?"
- 29 *And Jesus answered and said unto them, I will also ask of you one question, and answer me, and I will tell you by what authority I do these things.* Jesus said to them, "I will ask You one question. Answer Me and I will tell You by what authority I do these things."
- 30 *The baptism of John, was it from heaven, or of men? answer me.* "Was the baptism of John from heaven or from men? Answer Me."
- 31 *And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say, Why then did ye not believe him?* They argued among themselves: "If we say, 'From heaven,' He will ask, 'Then why did You not believe Him?'"
- 32 *But if we shall say, Of men; they feared the people: for all men counted John, that he was a prophet indeed.* "But if we say, 'From men' —" they feared the people, for everyone regarded John as truly a prophet.
- 33 *And they answered and said unto Jesus, We cannot tell. And Jesus answering saith unto them, Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.* So they answered Jesus, "We do not know." Jesus said to them, "Neither will I tell You by what authority I do these things."

Words in this chapter:

Hosanna (*ho-ZAN-ah*) — Hebrew cry meaning 'Save us, we pray!' — used as a shout of praise and welcome for the coming King.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 21:1-11; Luke 19:29-40; John 12:14-19
v2 — Matt 21:2-3; Luke 19:30-31
v7 — Luke 19:35-36; Zech 9:9; Matt 21:4-5; Matt 21:7-8
v9 — Ps 118:25-26; Matt 21:9; Matt 23:39; Luke 19:37-38
v10 — Ezek 37:24-25; Luke 2:14; Luke 19:38-40
v14 — Matt 21:19; Matt 7:19; Matt 3:10; John 15:6; Mark 11:20-21
v15 — John 2:13-17; Matt 21:12-16; Luke 19:45-47
v17 — Isa 56:7; Jer 7:11; Luke 19:46; John 2:16; 1 Kgs 8:41-48
v22 — Ps 62:8; John 14:1; Mark 9:23; 2 Chr 20:20; Isa 7:9

v23 — Matt 17:20; John 15:7; Matt 21:21; Ps 37:4; John 14:13

v24 — Matt 21:22; 1 John 5:14-15; 1 John 3:22; Jas 1:5-6; Matt 18:19

v25 — Matt 6:14-15; Col 3:13; Eph 4:32; Luke 6:37; Matt 6:12

Chapter 12

Jesus tells the parable of the wicked husbandmen and silences the Pharisees, Herodians, and Sadducees who try to trap Him with questions about tribute, the resurrection, and the greatest commandment. He warns against the scribes and commends a poor widow who casts two mites into the treasury.

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| <p>1 <i>And he began to speak unto them by parables. A certain man planted a vineyard, and set an hedge about it, and digged a place for the winefat, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country.</i></p> | <p>He began to speak to them in parables. "A man planted a vineyard. He put a wall around it, dug a pit for a winepress, and built a watchtower. He rented it to farmers and went away on a journey."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And at the season he sent to the husbandmen a servant, that he might receive from the husbandmen of the fruit of the vineyard.</i></p> | <p>At harvest time He sent a servant to the farmers to collect some of the fruit of the vineyard from them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they caught him, and beat him, and sent him away empty.</i></p> | <p>But they seized the servant, beat him, and sent him away empty-handed.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And again he sent unto them another servant; and at him they cast stones, and wounded him in the head, and sent him away shamefully handled.</i></p> | <p>He sent another servant to them. They struck Him on the head and treated Him shamefully.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And again he sent another; and him they killed, and many others; beating some, and killing some.</i></p> | <p>He sent still another, and that one they killed. He sent many others — they beat some and killed others.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Having yet therefore one son, his wellbeloved, he sent him also last unto them, saying, They will reverence my son.</i></p> | <p>He had one more to send — a beloved son. He sent Him last of all, saying, "They will respect my son."</p> |

- 7 *But those husbandmen said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and the inheritance shall be ours.* But those farmers said to one another, 'This is the heir. Come, let us kill Him and the inheritance will be ours.'
- 8 *And they took him, and killed him, and cast him out of the vineyard.* They took Him, killed Him, and threw Him out of the vineyard.
- 9 *What shall therefore the lord of the vineyard do? he will come and destroy the husbandmen, and will give the vineyard unto others.* What then will the owner of the vineyard do? He will come and destroy the farmers and give the vineyard to others.
- 10 *And have ye not read this scripture; The stone which the builders rejected is become the head of the corner:* Have You not read this scripture: 'The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone.'
- 11 *This was the Lord's doing, and it is marvellous in our eyes?* 'This is the Lord's doing, and it is marvelous in our eyes?'
- 12 *And they sought to lay hold on him, but feared the people: for they knew that he had spoken the parable against them: and they left him, and went their way.* They wanted to arrest Him but were afraid of the crowd, because they understood He had spoken the parable against them. So they left Him and went away.
- 13 *And they send unto him certain of the Pharisees and of the Herodians, to catch him in his words.* They sent some of the Pharisees and Herodians to catch Him in His words.
- 14 *And when they were come, they say unto him, Master, we know that thou art true, and carest for no man: for thou regardest not the person of men, but teachest the way of God in truth: Is it lawful to give tribute to Caesar, or not?* They came and said to Him, "Master, we know that You are truthful and show no partiality to anyone. You do not look at the outward appearance of men but teach the way of God truthfully. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar or not?"
- 15 *Shall we give, or shall we not give? But he, knowing their hypocrisy, said unto them, Why tempt ye me? bring me a penny, that I may see it.* "Should we pay or not?" Knowing their hypocrisy, He said to them, "Why are You testing Me? Bring Me a denarius so I can look at it."

- 16 *And they brought it. And he saith unto them, Whose is this image and superscription? And they said unto him, Caesar's.* They brought one. He asked, "Whose image and inscription is this?" "Caesar's," they said.
- 17 *And Jesus answering said unto them, Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's. And they marvelled at him.* Jesus said to them, "Give to Caesar what is Caesar's, and to God what is God's." They were amazed at Him.
- 18 *Then come unto him the Sadducees, which say there is no resurrection; and they asked him, saying,* Then the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to Him and asked,
- 19 *Master, Moses wrote unto us, If a man's brother die, and leave his wife behind him, and leave no children, that his brother should take his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.* "Master, Moses wrote for us that if a man's brother dies and leaves a wife but no children, the man must take the widow and raise up offspring for his brother."
- 20 *Now there were seven brethren: and the first took a wife, and dying left no seed.* There were seven brothers. The first one took a wife and died without leaving children.
- 21 *And the second took her, and died, neither left he any seed: and the third likewise.* The second one married the widow and also died without leaving children. The third did the same.
- 22 *And the seven had her, and left no seed: last of all the woman died also.* In fact, none of the seven left children. Last of all, the woman died too.
- 23 *In the resurrection therefore, when they shall rise, whose wife shall she be of them? for the seven had her to wife.* At the resurrection, whose wife will she be? For all seven were married to her."
- 24 *And Jesus answering said unto them, Do ye not therefore err, because ye know not the scriptures, neither the power of God?* Jesus said to them, "Is this not the reason You are wrong — that You do not know the scriptures or the power of God?"

- 25 *For when they shall rise from the dead, they neither marry, nor are given in marriage; but are as the angels which are in heaven.* When the dead rise, they neither marry nor are given in marriage. They are like the angels in heaven.
- 26 *And as touching the dead, that they rise: have ye not read in the book of Moses, how in the bush God spake unto him, saying, I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob?* As for the dead rising — have you not read in the book of Moses, in the account of the burning bush, how God said to Him, 'I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob'?
- 27 *He is not the God of the dead, but the God of the living: ye therefore do greatly err.* He is not the God of the dead but of the living. You are badly mistaken."
- 28 *And one of the scribes came, and having heard them reasoning together, and perceiving that he had answered them well, asked him, Which is the first commandment of all?* One of the scribes came and heard them arguing. When He noticed that Jesus had given them a good answer, He asked Him, "Which is the first commandment of all?"
- 29 *And Jesus answered him, The first of all the commandments is, Hear, O Israel; The Lord our God is one Lord:* Jesus answered, "The first is: 'Hear, O Israel — the Lord our God is one Lord.'"
- 30 *And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind, and with all thy strength: this is the first commandment.* "'You shall love the Lord Your God with all Your heart, and with all Your soul, and with all Your mind, and with all Your strength.' This is the first commandment."
- 31 *And the second is like, namely this, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. There is none other commandment greater than these.* "The second is this: 'You shall love Your neighbor as Yourself.' There is no other commandment greater than these."
- 32 *And the scribe said unto him, Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he:* The scribe said to him, "Well said, Master. You have spoken the truth — that He is one and there is no other besides Him."

- 33 *And to love him with all the heart, and with all the understanding, and with all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbour as himself, is more than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.* "To love Him with all the heart, all the understanding, and all the strength, and to love one's neighbor as oneself — that is worth more than all burnt offerings and sacrifices."
- 34 *And when Jesus saw that he answered discreetly, he said unto him, Thou art not far from the kingdom of God. And no man after that durst ask him any question.* When Jesus saw that He answered wisely, He said to Him, "You are not far from the kingdom of God." After that no one dared to ask him any more questions.
- 35 *And Jesus answered and said, while he taught in the temple, How say the scribes that Christ is the son of David?* While He was teaching in the temple, Jesus said, "How can the scribes say that the Christ is the son of David?"
- 36 *For David himself said by the Holy Ghost, The LORD said to my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool.* David himself, speaking by the Holy Ghost, said: 'The LORD said to my Lord, Sit at My right hand, until I make Your enemies Your footstool.'
- 37 *David therefore himself calleth him Lord; and whence is he then his son? And the common people heard him gladly.* David himself calls him 'Lord.' How then can he be his son?" The large crowd listened to Him with delight.
- 38 *And he said unto them in his doctrine, Beware of the scribes, which love to go in long clothing, and love salutations in the marketplaces,* In His teaching He said, "Watch out for the scribes. They like to walk around in long robes and receive greetings in the marketplaces."
- 39 *And the chief seats in the synagogues, and the uppermost rooms at feasts:* "They love the best seats in the synagogues and the places of honor at feasts."
- 40 *Which devour widows' houses, and for a pretence make long prayers: these shall receive greater damnation.* "They devour widows' houses and for a show make long prayers. These men will receive greater damnation."

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| <p>41 <i>And Jesus sat over against the treasury, and beheld how the people cast money into the treasury: and many that were rich cast in much.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And he called unto him his disciples, and saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury:</i></p> <p>44 <i>For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.</i></p> | <p>Jesus sat across from the treasury and watched the crowd putting money into it. Many rich people put in large amounts.</p> <p>But a poor widow came and put in two small copper coins, worth only a fraction of a penny.</p> <p>He called His disciples together and said, "Truly I tell You, this poor widow has put more into the treasury than all the others."</p> <p>"They all gave out of their wealth. But she, out of her poverty, put in everything — all she had to live on."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

Sadducees (*SAD-yoo-seez*) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Isa 5:1-4; Mark 13:34; Song 8:11-12; Rom 11:17-24; Matt 25:14
- v10** — Ps 118:22-23; Luke 20:17-18; Isa 28:16; 1 Pet 2:7-8; Acts 4:11-12
- v24** — 2 Tim 3:15-17; John 20:9; Matt 22:29; Eph 1:19; Isa 25:8
- v25** — Luke 20:35-36; Matt 22:30; 1 John 3:2
- v29** — Deut 6:4; Luke 10:27; Gal 3:20; Rom 3:30; 1 Cor 8:4
- v30** — Deut 6:5
- v31** — Rom 13:8-9; Matt 22:39; Lev 19:18; Luke 10:27; 1 Cor 13:4-8
- v32** — Deut 4:39; Isa 46:9; Deut 4:35; Isa 45:14; Isa 45:5-6
- v33** — Hos 6:6; Mic 6:6-8; 1 Sam 15:22; Matt 9:13; Matt 12:7

v36 — Ps 110:1; Matt 22:43-45; Heb 1:13; 1 Cor 15:25; Heb 10:12-13

v38 — Matt 23:1-7; Luke 20:45-47; Luke 11:43; Matt 6:5

v44 — 2 Cor 8:2-3; 1 John 3:17; Ezra 2:68-69; Luke 21:2-4; Mark 14:8

Chapter 13

Jesus foretells the destruction of the temple and the signs of the end, including wars, earthquakes, famines, and false Christs. He describes His coming in the clouds with great power and glory and warns His disciples to watch, for no one knows the day or the hour.

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| 1 <i>And as he went out of the temple, one of his disciples saith unto him, Master, see what manner of stones and what buildings are here!</i> | As Jesus was leaving the temple, one of His disciples said to Him, "Master, look — what stones and what buildings!" |
| 2 <i>And Jesus answering said unto him, Seest thou these great buildings? there shall not be left one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.</i> | Jesus said to Him, "Do You see these great buildings? Not one stone will be left on another — every one will be thrown down." |
| 3 <i>And as he sat upon the mount of Olives over against the temple, Peter and James and John and Andrew asked him privately,</i> | As He was sitting on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple, Peter, James, John, and Andrew asked him privately, |
| 4 <i>Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign when all these things shall be fulfilled?</i> | "Tell us, when will these things happen? What will be the sign that all these things are about to be fulfilled?" |
| 5 <i>And Jesus answering them began to say, Take heed lest any man deceive you:</i> | Jesus began to say to them, "Watch out that no one deceives you." |
| 6 <i>For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.</i> | "Many will come in My name, saying, 'I am Christ,' and will deceive many." |
| 7 <i>And when ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars, be ye not troubled: for such things must needs be; but the end shall not be yet.</i> | "When You hear of wars and reports of wars, do not be alarmed. Such things must happen, but the end is not yet." |

- 8 *For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be earthquakes in divers places, and there shall be famines and troubles: these are the beginnings of sorrows.* "Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be earthquakes in various places, and there will be famines and troubles. These are the beginnings of sorrows."
- 9 *But take heed to yourselves: for they shall deliver you up to councils; and in the synagogues ye shall be beaten: and ye shall be brought before rulers and kings for my sake, for a testimony against them.* "You must watch out for yourselves. They will hand You over to the courts. You will be beaten in the synagogues. You will stand before governors and kings for My sake, as a testimony to them."
- 10 *And the gospel must first be published among all nations.* "The gospel must first be proclaimed to all nations."
- 11 *But when they shall lead you, and deliver you up, take no thought beforehand what ye shall speak, neither do ye premeditate: but whatsoever shall be given you in that hour, that speak ye: for it is not ye that speak, but the Holy Ghost.* "When they arrest You and hand You over, do not worry beforehand about what to say. Say whatever is given You in that hour, for it is not You who speak but the Holy Ghost."
- 12 *Now the brother shall betray the brother to death, and the father the son; and children shall rise up against their parents, and shall cause them to be put to death.* "Brother will betray brother to death, and a father His child. Children will rise against their parents and have them put to death."
- 13 *And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.* "You will be hated by everyone because of My name. But the one who stands firm to the end will be saved."

- 14 *But when ye shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not, (let him that readeth understand,) then let them that be in Judaea flee to the mountains:* "When you see the abomination of desolation spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not — let the reader understand — then those who are in Judaea should flee to the mountains."
- 15 *And let him that is on the housetop not go down into the house, neither enter therein, to take any thing out of his house:* "Let no one on the housetop go down or enter the house to take anything out."
- 16 *And let him that is in the field not turn back again for to take up his garment.* "Let no one in the field go back to get his cloak."
- 17 *But woe to them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!* "How terrible it will be in those days for pregnant women and for nursing mothers!"
- 18 *And pray ye that your flight be not in the winter.* "Pray that your flight will not take place in winter."
- 19 *For in those days shall be affliction, such as was not from the beginning of the creation which God created unto this time, neither shall be.* "For in those days there will be such distress as has not been seen from the beginning of God's creation until now, and will never be seen again."
- 20 *And except that the Lord had shortened those days, no flesh should be saved: but for the elect's sake, whom he hath chosen, he hath shortened the days.* "If the Lord had not cut short those days, no one would survive. But for the sake of the elect, whom He has chosen, He has cut them short."
- 21 *And then if any man shall say to you, Lo, here is Christ; or, lo, he is there; believe him not:* "At that time if anyone says to you, 'Look, here is the Christ!' or 'Look, there He is!' — do not believe it."
- 22 *For false Christs and false prophets shall rise, and shall shew signs and wonders, to seduce, if it were possible, even the elect.* "For false Christs and false prophets will appear and perform signs and miracles to deceive, if possible, even the elect."

- 23 *But take ye heed: behold, I have foretold you all things.* "But watch out — I have told You everything ahead of time."
- 24 *But in those days, after that tribulation, the sun shall be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light,* "But in those days, after that tribulation, the sun will be darkened and the moon will not give its light."
- 25 *And the stars of heaven shall fall, and the powers that are in heaven shall be shaken.* "The stars will fall from the sky, and the powers in the heavens will be shaken."
- 26 *And then shall they see the Son of man coming in the clouds with great power and glory.* "Then they will see the Son of Man coming in clouds with great power and glory."
- 27 *And then shall he send his angels, and shall gather together his elect from the four winds, from the uttermost part of the earth to the uttermost part of heaven.* "He will send out His angels and gather His elect from the four winds, from the farthest end of the earth to the farthest end of heaven."
- 28 *Now learn a parable of the fig tree; When her branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is near:* "Now learn this lesson from the fig tree. When its branch becomes tender and puts out leaves, You know that summer is near."
- 29 *So ye in like manner, when ye shall see these things come to pass, know that it is nigh, even at the doors.* "In the same way, when You see these things happening, know that it is near — right at the door."
- 30 *Verily I say unto you, that this generation shall not pass, till all these things be done.* "Truly I tell You, this generation will not pass away until all these things have happened."
- 31 *Heaven and earth shall pass away: but my words shall not pass away.* "Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will never pass away."
- 32 *But of that day and that hour knoweth no man, no, not the angels which are in heaven, neither the Son, but the Father.* "But about that day or hour no one knows — not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father."

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| 33 <i>Take ye heed, watch and pray: for ye know not when the time is.</i> | "Watch out! Stay alert and pray. You do not know when that time will come." |
| 34 <i>For the Son of man is as a man taking a far journey, who left his house, and gave authority to his servants, and to every man his work, and commanded the porter to watch.</i> | "It is like a man going on a journey. He leaves his house and puts His servants in charge, each with their assigned task. He commands the doorkeeper to keep watch." |
| 35 <i>Watch ye therefore: for ye know not when the master of the house cometh, at even, or at midnight, or at the cockcrow, or in the morning:</i> | "Therefore keep watch — for You do not know when the master of the house will come: whether in the evening, at midnight, at the crow of the rooster, or in the morning." |
| 36 <i>Lest coming suddenly he find you sleeping.</i> | "If He comes suddenly, do not let Him find You sleeping." |
| 37 <i>And what I say unto you I say unto all, Watch.</i> | "What I say to You I say to everyone: Watch!" |

Words in this chapter:

Daniel (*DAN-yel*) — A young Judean nobleman taken to Babylon — remained faithful to God despite pressure; received visions of world empires and the end of days; his name means 'God is my judge.'

Cross-References:

v11 — Luke 21:14-15; Luke 12:11-12; Matt 10:19-21; Acts 6:10; 1 Cor 2:13

v13 — John 15:18-19; Matt 10:22; Luke 6:22; Matt 24:13; Gal 6:9

v14 — Dan 9:27; Dan 12:11; Dan 11:31; Matt 24:15-28; Luke 21:20-24

v22 — Matt 24:24; 2 Thess 2:8-14; Mark 13:6; Matt 7:15; 1 John 2:26

v26 — Rev 1:7; Matt 16:27; Matt 24:30; Mark 14:62; Matt 25:31

v30 — Matt 24:34; Luke 21:32

v31 — Isa 40:8; Isa 51:6; Matt 24:35; Luke 21:33; Matt 5:18

v32 — Matt 24:36-42; Acts 1:7; Matt 25:13; Rev 3:3; 1 Thess 5:1-2

v33 — Luke 12:40; Rom 13:11-12; Eph 6:18; Rev 16:15; 1 Pet 4:7

v35 — Matt 24:42; Mark 13:33; Matt 24:44

v36 — 1 Thess 5:6-7; Rom 13:11-14; Matt 24:48-51; Luke 21:34; Mark 14:40

v37 — Luke 12:41-46; Mark 13:33; Mark 13:35

Chapter 14

A woman anoints Jesus with costly spikenard at Bethany, and Judas agrees to betray Him. Jesus observes the Last Supper, prays in the Garden of Gethsemane, is betrayed by Judas, arrested, tried before the high priest, and denied three times by Peter.

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| <p>1 <i>After two days was the feast of the passover, and of unleavened bread: and the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might take him by craft, and put him to death.</i></p> <p>2 <i>But they said, Not on the feast day, lest there be an uproar of the people.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And being in Bethany in the house of Simon the leper, as he sat at meat, there came a woman having an alabaster box of ointment of spikenard very precious; and she brake the box, and poured it on his head.</i></p> <p>4 <i>And there were some that had indignation within themselves, and said, Why was this waste of the ointment made?</i></p> <p>5 <i>For it might have been sold for more than three hundred pence, and have been given to the poor. And they murmured against her.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And Jesus said, Let her alone; why trouble ye her? she hath wrought a good work on me.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For ye have the poor with you always, and whensoever ye will ye may do them good: but me ye have not always.</i></p> <p>8 <i>She hath done what she could: she is come aforehand to anoint my body to the burying.</i></p> | <p>The Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread were two days away. The chief priests and scribes were looking for a way to arrest Jesus by stealth and kill Him.</p> <p>"But not during the feast," they said, "or the people may riot."</p> <p>While Jesus was in Bethany, reclining at table in the house of Simon the leper, a woman came with an alabaster jar of very expensive perfume made of pure nard. She broke the jar and poured the perfume on His head.</p> <p>Some who were there were indignant and said to each other, "Why this waste of perfume?"</p> <p>"It could have been sold for more than three hundred denarii and the money given to the poor." They rebuked her harshly.</p> <p>Jesus said, "Leave her alone. Why are You bothering her? She has done a beautiful thing to Me."</p> <p>"The poor You will always have with You, and You can help them whenever You wish. But You will not always have Me."</p> <p>"She did what she could. She anointed My body beforehand for burial."</p> |
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- 9 *Verily I say unto you, Wheresoever this gospel shall be preached throughout the whole world, this also that she hath done shall be spoken of for a memorial of her.* "Truly I tell You, wherever the gospel is preached throughout the whole world, what she has done will also be told in memory of her."
- 10 *And Judas Iscariot, one of the twelve, went unto the chief priests, to betray him unto them.* Judas Iscariot, one of the twelve, went to the chief priests to betray Jesus to them.
- 11 *And when they heard it, they were glad, and promised to give him money. And he sought how he might conveniently betray him.* When they heard this they were delighted and promised to give him money. So Judas watched for a good opportunity to hand him over.
- 12 *And the first day of unleavened bread, when they killed the passover, his disciples said unto him, Where wilt thou that we go and prepare that thou mayest eat the passover?* On the first day of the Feast of Unleavened Bread, when the Passover lamb was sacrificed, His disciples asked Him, "Where do You want us to go and prepare for You to eat the Passover?"
- 13 *And he sendeth forth two of his disciples, and saith unto them, Go ye into the city, and there shall meet you a man bearing a pitcher of water: follow him.* He sent two of His disciples and said to them, "Go into the city. A man carrying a jar of water will meet you. Follow him."
- 14 *And wheresoever he shall go in, say ye to the goodman of the house, The Master saith, Where is the guestchamber, where I shall eat the passover with my disciples?* "Wherever he enters, tell the owner of the house, 'The Master says: Where is My guest room where I may eat the Passover with My disciples?'"
- 15 *And he will shew you a large upper room furnished and prepared: there make ready for us.* "He will show you a large upper room, furnished and ready. Make preparations for us there."
- 16 *And his disciples went forth, and came into the city, and found as he had said unto them: and they made ready the passover.* The disciples left and went into the city. They found things just as He had told them and prepared the Passover.

- 17 *And in the evening he cometh with the twelve.* When evening came, He arrived with the twelve.
- 18 *And as they sat and did eat, Jesus said, Verily I say unto you, One of you which eateth with me shall betray me.* While they were reclining and eating, Jesus said, "Truly I tell You, one of You will betray Me — one who is eating with Me."
- 19 *And they began to be sorrowful, and to say unto him one by one, Is it I? and another said, Is it I?* They were grieved and began to say to Him one by one, "Is it I?" And another said, "Is it I?"
- 20 *And he answered and said unto them, It is one of the twelve, that dippeth with me in the dish.* He said to them, "It is one of the twelve — one who dips bread into the bowl with Me."
- 21 *The Son of man indeed goeth, as it is written of him: but woe to that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! good were it for that man if he had never been born.* "The Son of Man goes as it is written about Him. But woe to that man by whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would have been better for that man if he had never been born."
- 22 *And as they did eat, Jesus took bread, and blessed, and brake it, and gave to them, and said, Take, eat: this is my body.* While they were eating, Jesus took bread, gave thanks, and broke it. He gave it to them and said, "Take — this is My body."
- 23 *And he took the cup, and when he had given thanks, he gave it to them: and they all drank of it.* Then He took a cup, and when He had given thanks He gave it to them, and they all drank from it.
- 24 *And he said unto them, This is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many.* He said to them, "This is My blood of the new testament, which is shed for many."
- 25 *Verily I say unto you, I will drink no more of the fruit of the vine, until that day that I drink it new in the kingdom of God.* "Truly I tell You, I will not drink again of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new in the kingdom of God."
- 26 *And when they had sung an hymn, they went out into the mount of Olives.* When they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.

- 27 *And Jesus saith unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered.* Jesus said to them, "You will all fall away because of Me this night. For it is written: 'I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered.'"
- 28 *But after that I am risen, I will go before you into Galilee.* "But after I am raised up, I will go before You into Galilee."
- 29 *But Peter said unto him, Although all shall be offended, yet will not I.* Peter said to him, "Even if everyone falls away, I will not."
- 30 *And Jesus saith unto him, Verily I say unto thee, That this day, even in this night, before the cock crow twice, thou shalt deny me thrice.* Jesus said to Him, "Truly I tell You, today — this very night — before the rooster crows twice, You will deny Me three times."
- 31 *But he spake the more vehemently, If I should die with thee, I will not deny thee in any wise. Likewise also said they all.* But Peter insisted all the more, "Even if I have to die with You, I will never deny You." All the others said the same.
- 32 *And they came to a place which was named Gethsemane: and he saith to his disciples, Sit ye here, while I shall pray.* They came to a place called Gethsemane. He said to His disciples, "Sit here while I pray."
- 33 *And he taketh with him Peter and James and John, and began to be sore amazed, and to be very heavy;* He took Peter, James, and John with him. He began to be deeply distressed and troubled.
- 34 *And saith unto them, My soul is exceeding sorrowful unto death: tarry ye here, and watch.* He said to them, "My soul is overwhelmed with sorrow to the point of death. Stay here and keep watch."
- 35 *And he went forward a little, and fell on the ground, and prayed that, if it were possible, the hour might pass from him.* Going a little farther, He fell to the ground and prayed that if possible the hour might pass from Him.

- 36 *And he said, Abba, Father, all things are possible unto thee; take away this cup from me: nevertheless not what I will, but what thou wilt.* He said, "Abba, Father, all things are possible for You. Take this cup from Me. Yet not what I will, but what You will."
- 37 *And he cometh, and findeth them sleeping, and saith unto Peter, Simon, sleepest thou? couldest not thou watch one hour?* He came back and found them sleeping. He said to Peter, "Simon, are you asleep? Could you not keep watch for one hour?"
- 38 *Watch ye and pray, lest ye enter into temptation. The spirit truly is ready, but the flesh is weak.* "Watch and pray so that you do not enter into temptation. The spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak."
- 39 *And again he went away, and prayed, and spake the same words.* He went away again and prayed, saying the same words.
- 40 *And when he returned, he found them asleep again, (for their eyes were heavy,) neither wist they what to answer him.* When He came back, He again found them sleeping, because their eyes were heavy. They did not know what to say to Him.
- 41 *And he cometh the third time, and saith unto them, Sleep on now, and take your rest: it is enough, the hour is come; behold, the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.* He came back a third time and said to them, "Are You still sleeping and resting? Enough! The hour has come. The Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners."
- 42 *Rise up, let us go; lo, he that betrayeth me is at hand.* "Get up, let us go. Look — My betrayer is near."
- 43 *And immediately, while he yet spake, cometh Judas, one of the twelve, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and the scribes and the elders.* At once, while He was still speaking, Judas — one of the twelve — arrived. With him was a large crowd armed with swords and clubs, sent from the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders.
- 44 *And he that betrayed him had given them a token, saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he; take him, and lead him away safely.* The betrayer had given them a signal: "The man I kiss is the one. Arrest him and lead him away securely."

- 45 *And as soon as he was come, he goeth straightway to him, and saith, Master, master; and kissed him.* Going at once to Jesus, Judas said, "Rabbi, Rabbi!" and kissed him.
- 46 *And they laid their hands on him, and took him.* The men seized Jesus and arrested Him.
- 47 *And one of them that stood by drew a sword, and smote a servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear.* One of those standing nearby drew his sword and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear.
- 48 *And Jesus answered and said unto them, Are ye come out, as against a thief, with swords and with staves to take me?* Jesus said to them, "Have You come out with swords and clubs to arrest Me as though I were a robber?"
- 49 *I was daily with you in the temple teaching, and ye took me not: but the scriptures must be fulfilled.* "Every day I was with You in the temple teaching, and You did not arrest Me. But the scriptures must be fulfilled."
- 50 *And they all forsook him, and fled.* Then all His disciples left Him and fled.
- 51 *And there followed him a certain young man, having a linen cloth cast about his naked body; and the young men laid hold on him:* A young man was following Him, wearing nothing but a linen cloth over His body. They grabbed Him,
- 52 *And he left the linen cloth, and fled from them naked.* but He left the linen cloth and ran away naked.
- 53 *And they led Jesus away to the high priest: and with him were assembled all the chief priests and the elders and the scribes.* They led Jesus to the high priest. All the chief priests, elders, and scribes gathered together.
- 54 *And Peter followed him afar off, even into the palace of the high priest: and he sat with the servants, and warmed himself at the fire.* Peter followed Jesus at a distance, right into the courtyard of the high priest. He sat with the guards and warmed Himself at the fire.

- 55 *And the chief priests and all the council sought for witness against Jesus to put him to death; and found none.* The chief priests and the whole council were looking for testimony against Jesus in order to put Him to death. But they found none.
- 56 *For many bare false witness against him, but their witness agreed not together.* Many gave false testimony against Him, but their testimony did not agree.
- 57 *And there arose certain, and bare false witness against him, saying,* Some stood up and gave this false testimony against Him:
- 58 *We heard him say, I will destroy this temple that is made with hands, and within three days I will build another made without hands.* "We heard Him say, 'I will destroy this temple made with hands and in three days build another not made with hands.'"
- 59 *But neither so did their witness agree together.* But even on this point their testimony did not agree.
- 60 *And the high priest stood up in the midst, and asked Jesus, saying, Answerest thou nothing? what is it which these witness against thee?* Then the high priest stood up in the middle and asked Jesus, "Do You have no answer? What is this testimony these men are bringing against You?"
- 61 *But he held his peace, and answered nothing. Again the high priest asked him, and said unto him, Art thou the Christ, the Son of the Blessed?* But Jesus remained silent and gave no answer. The high priest asked Him again, "Are You the Christ, the Son of the Blessed One?"
- 62 *And Jesus said, I am: and ye shall see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.* Jesus said, "I am. And You will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power and coming with the clouds of heaven."
- 63 *Then the high priest rent his clothes, and saith, What need we any further witnesses?* The high priest tore His clothes. "What further need do we have of witnesses?" he said.
- 64 *Ye have heard the blasphemy: what think ye? And they all condemned him to be guilty of death.* "You have heard the blasphemy. What do You think?" They all condemned Him as deserving death.

- 65 *And some began to spit on him, and to cover his face, and to buffet him, and to say unto him, Prophecy: and the servants did strike him with the palms of their hands.* Some began to spit on Him. They blindfolded Him and struck Him, saying, "Prophecy!" The guards also took Him and beat Him.
- 66 *And as Peter was beneath in the palace, there cometh one of the maids of the high priest:* While Peter was below in the courtyard, one of the servant girls of the high priest came by.
- 67 *And when she saw Peter warming himself, she looked upon him, and said, And thou also wast with Jesus of Nazareth.* When she saw Peter warming himself, she looked at him and said, "You also were with Jesus of Nazareth."
- 68 *But he denied, saying, I know not, neither understand I what thou sayest. And he went out into the porch; and the cock crew.* But He denied it. "I don't know or understand what You're talking about," he said. He went out into the entrance, and a rooster crowed.
- 69 *And a maid saw him again, and began to say to them that stood by, This is one of them.* The servant girl saw him there and again said to those standing nearby, "This man is one of them."
- 70 *And he denied it again. And a little after, they that stood by said again to Peter, Surely thou art one of them: for thou art a Galilaean, and thy speech agreeth thereto.* He denied it again. A little later those standing there said to Peter, "Surely you are one of them, for you are a Galilean."
- 71 *But he began to curse and to swear, saying, I know not this man of whom ye speak.* He began to call down curses, and he swore, "I do not know this man you are talking about."
- 72 *And the second time the cock crew. And Peter called to mind the word that Jesus said unto him, Before the cock crow twice, thou shalt deny me thrice. And when he thought thereon, he wept.* At once a rooster crowed a second time. Peter remembered how Jesus had said to Him, "Before the rooster crows twice, You will deny Me three times." He broke down and wept.

- Abba** (*AB-ah*) — Aramaic word for 'Father' — an intimate address to God, showing the believer's adoption as God's child.
- passover** — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.
- Gethsemane** (*geth-SEM-ah-nee*) — A garden at the foot of the Mount of Olives — the place where Jesus prayed the night of His betrayal; his name means 'olive press.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ex 12:6-20; Luke 22:1-2; John 13:1; Deut 16:1-8
- v3 — Luke 7:37-39; John 12:1-8; John 11:2; Matt 26:6-13
- v9 — Matt 26:12-13; Mark 16:15; Matt 24:14
- v22 — Matt 26:26-29; Mark 14:24; 1 Cor 10:16-17; 1 Cor 11:23-29
- v24 — Zech 9:11; Ex 24:8; Rev 7:9-17; Heb 9:15-23
- v27 — Zech 13:7; John 16:32; Matt 26:31
- v28 — Matt 28:16; Mark 16:7; Matt 28:7; Matt 28:10; Matt 26:32
- v36 — Gal 4:6; John 5:30; Rom 8:15-16; Heb 5:7-8; John 12:27
- v38 — Matt 26:41; Luke 21:36; Matt 24:42; Rom 7:18-25; Luke 22:40
- v61 — Matt 26:63-64; Mark 15:2; Isa 53:7
- v62 — Dan 7:13-14; Ps 110:1; Heb 1:3; Mark 13:26; Matt 24:30
- v65 — Matt 26:67-68; Acts 23:2; John 19:3; Luke 22:63-64; Isa 50:6

Chapter 15

Jesus is delivered to Pontius Pilate, who offers to release Him, but the crowd demands Barabbas. The soldiers mock Jesus, crown Him with thorns, and crucify Him at Golgotha. He cries out, gives up His spirit, and Joseph of Arimathaea buries Him in a tomb hewn from rock.

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| 1 <i>And straightway in the morning the chief priests held a consultation with the elders and scribes and the whole council, and bound Jesus, and carried him away, and delivered him to Pilate.</i> | Very early in the morning the chief priests, with the elders, scribes, and the whole council, reached a decision. They bound Jesus, led Him away, and handed Him over to Pilate. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Pilate** (PY-lut) — Latin, possibly "armed with a javelin" — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judaea who sentenced Jesus to crucifixion despite declaring Him innocent.

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| 2 <i>And Pilate asked him, Art thou the King of the Jews? And he answering said unto him, Thou sayest it.</i> | Pilate asked him, "Are you the King of the Jews?" Jesus answered, "You have said so." |
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| 3 | <i>And the chief priests accused him of many things: but he answered nothing.</i> | The chief priests accused Him of many things, but He answered nothing. |
| 4 | <i>And Pilate asked him again, saying, Answerest thou nothing? behold how many things they witness against thee.</i> | Pilate asked him again, "Do you have no answer? See how many things they are accusing You of." |
| 5 | <i>But Jesus yet answered nothing; so that Pilate marvelled.</i> | But Jesus still answered nothing, so that Pilate was amazed. |
| 6 | <i>Now at that feast he released unto them one prisoner, whomsoever they desired.</i> | Now at the feast He was accustomed to release to them one prisoner — whichever one they asked for. |
| 7 | <i>And there was one named Barabbas, which lay bound with them that had made insurrection with him, who had committed murder in the insurrection.</i> | A man called Barabbas was in prison with the rebels who had committed murder during the uprising. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Barabbas** (buh-RAB-us) — Aramaic, "son of the father" — A murderer and insurrectionist who was released instead of Jesus, a striking picture of substitution: the guilty set free while the innocent is condemned.

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| 8 | <i>And the multitude crying aloud began to desire him to do as he had ever done unto them.</i> | The crowd came up and began to ask Pilate to do for them as he always did. |
| 9 | <i>But Pilate answered them, saying, Will ye that I release unto you the King of the Jews?</i> | Pilate answered them, "Do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?" |
| 10 | <i>For he knew that the chief priests had delivered him for envy.</i> | He knew it was out of envy that the chief priests had handed Jesus over. |
| 11 | <i>But the chief priests moved the people, that he should rather release Barabbas unto them.</i> | But the chief priests stirred up the crowd to have Pilate release Barabbas to them instead. |
| 12 | <i>And Pilate answered and said again unto them, What will ye then that I shall do unto him whom ye call the King of the Jews?</i> | "What then do you want me to do with the man you call the King of the Jews?" Pilate asked. |

- 13 *And they cried out again, Crucify him.* They shouted back, "Crucify Him!"
- 14 *Then Pilate said unto them, Why, what evil hath he done? And they cried out the more exceedingly, Crucify him.* "Why? What crime has He committed?" Pilate asked. They shouted even louder, "Crucify him!"
- 15 *And so Pilate, willing to content the people, released Barabbas unto them, and delivered Jesus, when he had scourged him, to be crucified.* Wanting to satisfy the crowd, Pilate released Barabbas to them. He had Jesus flogged and handed Him over to be crucified.
- 16 *And the soldiers led him away into the hall, called Praetorium; and they call together the whole band.* The soldiers led Jesus away into the palace — that is, the Praetorium — and called the whole company of soldiers together.
- 17 *And they clothed him with purple, and platted a crown of thorns, and put it about his head,* They clothed Him in purple and twisted together a crown of thorns and set it on Him.
- 18 *And began to salute him, Hail, King of the Jews!* They began to call out to Him, "Hail, King of the Jews!"
- 19 *And they smote him on the head with a reed, and did spit upon him, and bowing their knees worshipped him.* They struck His head with a staff and spit on Him. Falling on their knees, they mocked worship before Him.
- 20 *And when they had mocked him, they took off the purple from him, and put his own clothes on him, and led him out to crucify him.* When they had finished mocking Him, they took off the purple robe and put His own clothes back on Him. Then they led Him out to crucify Him.
- 21 *And they compel one Simon a Cyrenian, who passed by, coming out of the country, the father of Alexander and Rufus, to bear his cross.* They forced a man named Simon of Cyrene, the father of Alexander and Rufus, who was coming in from the country, to carry His cross.
- 22 *And they bring him unto the place Golgotha, which is, being interpreted, The place of a skull.* They brought Jesus to the place called Golgotha — which means "The Place of a Skull."

- 23 *And they gave him to drink wine mingled with myrrh: but he received it not.* They offered Him wine mixed with myrrh, but He did not take it.
- 24 *And when they had crucified him, they parted his garments, casting lots upon them, what every man should take.* When they crucified Him, they divided His clothes by casting lots to decide what each would get.
- 25 *And it was the third hour, and they crucified him.* It was the third hour when they crucified Him.
- 26 *And the superscription of his accusation was written over, THE KING OF THE JEWS.* The written notice of the charge against Him read: THE KING OF THE JEWS.
- 27 *And with him they crucify two thieves; the one on his right hand, and the other on his left.* They crucified two robbers with Him, one on His right and one on His left.
- 28 *And the scripture was fulfilled, which saith, And he was numbered with the transgressors.* So the scripture was fulfilled which says, "And He was numbered with the transgressors."
- 29 *And they that passed by railed on him, wagging their heads, and saying, Ah, thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days,* Those who passed by hurled insults at Him, shaking their heads and saying, "So! You who would destroy the temple and build it in three days —"
- 30 *Save thyself, and come down from the cross.* "Come down from the cross and save Yourself!"
- 31 *Likewise also the chief priests mocking said among themselves with the scribes, He saved others; himself he cannot save.* In the same way the chief priests and scribes mocked Him among themselves. "He saved others," they said, "but He cannot save Himself!"
- 32 *Let Christ the King of Israel descend now from the cross, that we may see and believe. And they that were crucified with him reviled him.* "Let the Christ, the King of Israel, come down from the cross now so that we may see and believe." Those who were crucified with Him also insulted Him.

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| 33 | <i>And when the sixth hour was come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.</i> | When the sixth hour came, darkness fell over the whole land until the ninth hour. |
| 34 | <i>And at the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani? which is, being interpreted, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?</i> | At the ninth hour Jesus cried out in a loud voice, "Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani?" — which means, "My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?" |
| 35 | <i>And some of them that stood by, when they heard it, said, Behold, he calleth Elias.</i> | When some who stood by heard this, they said, "Listen, He is calling Elijah." |
| 36 | <i>And one ran and filled a sponge full of vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave him to drink, saying, Let alone; let us see whether Elias will come to take him down.</i> | Someone ran and filled a sponge with sour wine. He put it on a stick and offered it to Jesus to drink. "Let Him alone," He said. "Let us see whether Elijah will come to take him down." |
| 37 | <i>And Jesus cried with a loud voice, and gave up the ghost.</i> | Jesus cried out with a loud voice and gave up the spirit. |
| 38 | <i>And the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom.</i> | The curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. |
| 39 | <i>And when the centurion, which stood over against him, saw that he so cried out, and gave up the ghost, he said, Truly this man was the Son of God.</i> | When the centurion who stood facing him saw how he cried out and gave up the spirit, He said, "Truly this man was the Son of God." |
| 40 | <i>There were also women looking on afar off: among whom was Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James the less and of Joses, and Salome;</i> | There were also women watching from a distance. Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James the younger and of Joses, and Salome. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mary Magdalene** (MAIR-ee MAG-duh-leen) — "Mary from Magdala," a town on the western shore of the Sea of Galilee — She had been delivered of seven demons by Jesus and became one of His most devoted followers, the first to see Him after His resurrection.

- 41 *(Who also, when he was in Galilee, followed him, and ministered unto him;) and many other women which came up with him unto Jerusalem.* These women had followed Jesus and served Him when He was in Galilee. Many other women who had come up with Him to Jerusalem were also there.
- 42 *And now when the even was come, because it was the preparation, that is, the day before the sabbath,* When evening came, because it was the Day of Preparation — the day before the Sabbath —
- 43 *Joseph of Arimathaea, an honourable counsellor, which also waited for the kingdom of God, came, and went in boldly unto Pilate, and craved the body of Jesus.* Joseph of Arimathaea, a prominent council member who was Himself waiting for the kingdom of God, went boldly to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Joseph of Arimathaea** (JOH-zuf of air-ih-muh-THÉE-uh) — "Joseph from Arimathaea," a town northwest of Jerusalem — A wealthy member of the Sanhedrin who was a secret disciple of Jesus. He claimed the body of Jesus and placed it in his own new tomb.

- 44 *And Pilate marvelled if he were already dead: and calling unto him the centurion, he asked him whether he had been any while dead.* Pilate was surprised to hear that Jesus was already dead. He called the centurion and asked him if Jesus had been dead for some time.
- 45 *And when he knew it of the centurion, he gave the body to Joseph.* When he found out from the centurion that it was so, he gave the body to Joseph.
- 46 *And he bought fine linen, and took him down, and wrapped him in the linen, and laid him in a sepulchre which was hewn out of a rock, and rolled a stone unto the door of the sepulchre.* Joseph bought fine linen. He took Jesus down from the cross, wrapped Him in the linen, and placed Him in a tomb cut out of rock. He rolled a stone against the entrance of the tomb.
- 47 *And Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Joses beheld where he was laid.* Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Joses saw where he was laid.

Words in this chapter:

centurion (*sen-TYUR-ee-un*) — A Roman army officer commanding approximately 100 soldiers — several centurions in the NT show unusual faith in Jesus.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Pilate (*PY-lat*) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Simon of Cyrene (*sy-REEN*) — A man from Cyrene (North Africa) who was compelled by Roman soldiers to carry Jesus's cross to Golgotha.

Golgotha (*GOL-gah-thah*) — The hill outside Jerusalem where Jesus was crucified — an Aramaic word meaning 'place of the skull'; called Calvary in Latin.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Matt 2:2; Matt 27:11-14
- v15 — John 19:1; Isa 50:6; Matt 27:26
- v16 — Matt 27:27-31; John 19:9
- v21 — Matt 27:32; Luke 23:26; Rom 16:13
- v22 — Matt 27:33-44; John 19:17-27
- v24 — Luke 23:34; John 19:23-24; Matt 27:35-36
- v32 — Matt 27:44; Luke 23:39-43
- v33 — Matt 27:45; Luke 23:44-45; Amos 8:9-10; Mark 15:25; Isa 50:3-4
- v34 — Ps 22:1; Matt 27:46; Heb 5:7; Ps 27:9; Isa 41:17
- v38 — Heb 10:19-23; Luke 23:45; Matt 27:51-53; Heb 9:3-12; Lev 16:2-19
- v39 — Matt 27:54; Luke 23:47-48; Matt 27:43
- v40 — Matt 27:55-56; Luke 8:2-3; Luke 23:49

Chapter 16

Three women come to the tomb at sunrise and find the stone rolled away and an angel who tells them Jesus has risen. The risen Jesus appears to Mary Magdalene, to two disciples on the road, and to the eleven, commissioning them to preach the gospel to every creature before ascending into heaven.

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| 1 | <i>And when the sabbath was past, Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome, had bought sweet spices, that they might come and anoint him.</i> | When the Sabbath was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices so they could go and anoint Jesus. |
| 2 | <i>And very early in the morning the first day of the week, they came unto the sepulchre at the rising of the sun.</i> | Very early on the first day of the week, just after sunrise, they went to the tomb. |

- 3 *And they said among themselves, Who shall roll us away the stone from the door of the sepulchre?* They were asking each other, "Who will roll the stone away from the entrance of the tomb?"
- 4 *And when they looked, they saw that the stone was rolled away: for it was very great.* When they looked up, they saw that the stone had been rolled away — it was very large.
- 5 *And entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting on the right side, clothed in a long white garment; and they were affrighted.* As they entered the tomb, they saw a young man dressed in a white robe sitting on the right side. They were alarmed.
- 6 *And he saith unto them, Be not affrighted: Ye seek Jesus of Nazareth, which was crucified: he is risen; he is not here: behold the place where they laid him.* "Do not be alarmed," he said. "You are looking for Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified. He is risen! He is not here. See the place where they laid Him."
- 7 *But go your way, tell his disciples and Peter that he goeth before you into Galilee: there shall ye see him, as he said unto you.* "But go and tell His disciples — and Peter — that he is going ahead of you into Galilee. You will see Him there, just as He told you."
- 8 *And they went out quickly, and fled from the sepulchre; for they trembled and were amazed: neither said they any thing to any man; for they were afraid.* They went out and fled from the tomb. Trembling and amazed, they said nothing to anyone, for they were afraid.
- 9 *Now when Jesus was risen early the first day of the week, he appeared first to Mary Magdalene, out of whom he had cast seven devils.* When Jesus rose early on the first day of the week, He appeared first to Mary Magdalene, out of whom he had cast seven demons.
- 10 *And she went and told them that had been with him, as they mourned and wept.* She went and told those who had been with Him, as they mourned and wept.
- 11 *And they, when they had heard that he was alive, and had been seen of her, believed not.* When they heard that He was alive and had been seen by her, they did not believe it.

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| 12 <i>After that he appeared in another form unto two of them, as they walked, and went into the country.</i> | After this, He appeared in a different form to two of them as they walked along in the country. |
| 13 <i>And they went and told it unto the residue: neither believed they them.</i> | These two went back and told the rest, but they did not believe them either. |
| 14 <i>Afterward he appeared unto the eleven as they sat at meat, and upbraided them with their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they believed not them which had seen him after he was risen.</i> | Later He appeared to the eleven as they were eating. He rebuked them for their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they had not believed those who had seen Him after He rose. |
| 15 <i>And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.</i> | He said to them, "Go into all the world and preach the gospel to every creature." |
| 16 <i>He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved; but he that believeth not shall be damned.</i> | "Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be damned." |
| 17 <i>And these signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues;</i> | "These signs will accompany those who believe: In My name they will cast out demons. They will speak in new tongues." |
| 18 <i>They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.</i> | "They will pick up snakes with their hands. If they drink anything deadly, it will not harm them. They will lay their hands on the sick, and they will get well." |
| 19 <i>So then after the Lord had spoken unto them, he was received up into heaven, and sat on the right hand of God.</i> | After the Lord had spoken to them, He was taken up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of God. |
| 20 <i>And they went forth, and preached every where, the Lord working with them, and confirming the word with signs following. Amen.</i> | They went out and preached everywhere. The Lord worked with them and confirmed His word by the signs that followed. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Nazareth (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 23:56-24:12; Matt 28:1-10; John 20:1-10; Mark 15:40

v3 — Mark 15:46-47; Matt 27:60-66

v5 — John 20:11-12; Matt 28:3; John 20:8; Luke 24:3-5

v6 — Rev 1:17-18; 1 Cor 15:3-7; Luke 24:46; John 2:19-22; Matt 28:4-7

v7 — Mark 14:28; Matt 26:32; Matt 28:7; Matt 28:10; Matt 28:16-17

v14 — 1 Cor 15:5; Luke 24:36-43; Heb 3:7-8; Mark 8:17-18; John 20:27

v15 — Matt 28:19; Mark 13:10; Acts 1:8; Luke 24:47-48; Ps 96:3

v16 — John 11:25-26; John 3:36; Rom 10:9-14; John 3:18-19; John 3:15-16

v17 — Acts 5:16; 1 Cor 12:28; Luke 10:17; Acts 8:7; 1 Cor 12:10

v18 — Luke 10:19; Jas 5:14-15; Acts 28:3-6; Acts 19:12; Acts 4:30

v19 — 1 Pet 3:22; Heb 1:3; Heb 12:2; Ps 110:1; Rom 8:34

v20 — 1 Cor 2:4-5; Acts 14:3; Heb 2:4; Rom 15:19; Acts 8:4-6

Luke

Author: Luke, "the beloved physician" (Col 4:14) and travel companion of Paul — the only Gentile author in the NT. The same author wrote Acts; together Luke-Acts forms a two-volume work addressed to Theophilus.

Date written: c. AD 60–62, likely during Paul's imprisonment at Caesarea when Luke had access to eyewitnesses in Judea.

Written to: Theophilus — a Gentile, probably a Roman official of some rank — and through him the wider Gentile world seeking an orderly account of Christian origins.

Setting: Luke investigates "from the very first" (1:3), interviewing eyewitnesses and consulting sources to produce the most comprehensive of the four Gospels. He begins before the birth of John the Baptist and ends at the ascension.

Where this sits historically: Written during Nero's reign while Paul was imprisoned (in Caesarea c. AD 57–59 or Rome c. AD 60–62), with Festus and later Albinus governing Judea on the eve of the Jewish revolt.

Contemporaries: Paul was composing the prison epistles (Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, Philemon), Mark's Gospel was circulating, and James the Just was leading the Jerusalem church until his martyrdom around AD 62.

Big themes:

- Jesus as Saviour of all — Luke emphasizes Gentiles, women, the poor, and social outcasts more than any other Gospel; salvation is for everyone
- Prayer — Luke records Jesus praying more than any other Gospel writer; ten instances of prayer appear only in Luke
- The Holy Spirit — the Spirit is prominent from the birth narratives through to Pentecost; Luke-Acts together trace the Spirit's work
- Praise — the birth narrative contains four great hymns (Magnificat, Benedictus, Gloria, Nunc Dimittis) found only in Luke
- Parables of grace — the Good Samaritan, the Prodigal Son, and the Pharisee and Tax Collector are found only in Luke

Key passages: Luke 1:46–55; 2:10–11; 4:18; 15:20; 24:45–47

How it fits: Luke provides the most detailed infancy narrative and the most carefully ordered account of the journey to Jerusalem. His Gospel bridges from Jewish roots (the temple, the law, the prophets) to the universal mission that Acts then traces to Rome. Together Luke-Acts is the longest single contribution to the NT by any one author.

Chapter 1

The angel Gabriel appears to Zacharias in the temple, announcing that his wife Elisabeth will bear a son named John. Gabriel then visits the virgin Mary in Nazareth and tells her she will conceive the Son of the Highest by the Holy Ghost. Mary visits Elisabeth, sings the Magnificat, and John the Baptist is born.

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| 1 <i>Forasmuch as many have taken in hand to set forth in order a declaration of those things which are most surely believed among us,</i> | Many people have undertaken to write an account of the things that have been fulfilled among us. |
| 2 <i>Even as they delivered them unto us, which from the beginning were eyewitnesses, and ministers of the word;</i> | They wrote what was passed on to us by those who were eyewitnesses from the beginning and who became servants of the word. |
| 3 <i>It seemed good to me also, having had perfect understanding of all things from the very first, to write unto thee in order, most excellent Theophilus,</i> | It seemed good to me as well, having carefully investigated everything from the beginning, to write an orderly account for You, most excellent Theophilus. |
| 4 <i>That thou mightest know the certainty of those things, wherein thou hast been instructed.</i> | I write so that You may know the certainty of the things You have been taught. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Theophilus** (thee-AH-fih-lus) — "lover of God" — *The person to whom Luke addresses his Gospel and the book of Acts. He may have been a Roman official or a prominent Christian patron.*

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| 5 <i>There was in the days of Herod, the king of Judaea, a certain priest named Zacharias, of the course of Abia: and his wife was of the daughters of Aaron, and her name was Elisabeth.</i> | In the days of Herod, king of Judaea, there was a priest named Zacharias, of the division of Abijah. his wife was a descendant of Aaron, and her name was Elisabeth. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zacharias** (zak-uh-RY-us) — "the LORD has remembered" — *A priest of the division of Abijah, father of John the Baptist.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Elisabeth** (ih-LIZ-uh-beth) — "my God is an oath" or "my God is abundance" — *Wife of Zacharias and mother of John the Baptist, a descendant of Aaron.*

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| 6 <i>And they were both righteous before God, walking in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord blameless.</i> | Both of them were righteous before God. They walked in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord without fault. |
| 7 <i>And they had no child, because that Elisabeth was barren, and they both were now well stricken in years.</i> | They had no child, because Elisabeth was barren, and they were both very old. |
| 8 <i>And it came to pass, that while he executed the priest's office before God in the order of his course,</i> | One day while Zacharias was serving as priest before God in the order of His division, |
| 9 <i>According to the custom of the priest's office, his lot was to burn incense when he went into the temple of the Lord.</i> | it was his lot, according to the priestly custom, to enter the temple of the Lord and burn incense. |
| 10 <i>And the whole multitude of the people were praying without at the time of incense.</i> | The whole crowd of people was praying outside at the hour of incense. |
| 11 <i>And there appeared unto him an angel of the Lord standing on the right side of the altar of incense.</i> | An angel of the Lord appeared to Him, standing on the right side of the altar of incense. |
| 12 <i>And when Zacharias saw him, he was troubled, and fear fell upon him.</i> | When Zacharias saw him, he was troubled, and fear came over him. |
| 13 <i>But the angel said unto him, Fear not, Zacharias: for thy prayer is heard; and thy wife Elisabeth shall bear thee a son, and thou shalt call his name John.</i> | But the angel said to him, "Do not be afraid, Zacharias, for your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elisabeth will bear you a son, and you shall call his name John. |
| 14 <i>And thou shalt have joy and gladness; and many shall rejoice at his birth.</i> | You will have joy and gladness, and many will rejoice at his birth. |
| 15 <i>For he shall be great in the sight of the Lord, and shall drink neither wine nor strong drink; and he shall be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from his mother's womb.</i> | He will be great in the sight of the Lord. He will drink no wine or strong drink. He will be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from His mother's womb. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *The Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is an older English word for "spirit." The KJV consistently uses "Holy Ghost" in the New Testament.*

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| <p>16 <i>And many of the children of Israel shall he turn to the Lord their God.</i></p> | He will turn many of the children of Israel to the Lord their God. |
| <p>17 <i>And he shall go before him in the spirit and power of Elias, to turn the hearts of the fathers to the children, and the disobedient to the wisdom of the just; to make ready a people prepared for the Lord.</i></p> | He will go before Him in the spirit and power of Elijah, to turn the hearts of the fathers to the children and the disobedient to the wisdom of the righteous — to make ready a people prepared for the Lord." |
| <p>18 <i>And Zacharias said unto the angel, Whereby shall I know this? for I am an old man, and my wife well stricken in years.</i></p> | Zacharias said to the angel, "How will I know this? For I am an old man, and my wife is very old." |
| <p>19 <i>And the angel answering said unto him, I am Gabriel, that stand in the presence of God; and am sent to speak unto thee, and to shew thee these glad tidings.</i></p> | The angel answered him, "I am Gabriel. I stand in the presence of God, and I was sent to speak to you and to bring you this good news. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gabriel** (GAY-bree-ul) — *"God is my strength" — An archangel who stands in the presence of God. He also appeared to Daniel and to Mary.*

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| <p>20 <i>And, behold, thou shalt be dumb, and not able to speak, until the day that these things shall be performed, because thou believest not my words, which shall be fulfilled in their season.</i></p> | Because you did not believe my words, which will be fulfilled in their time, you will be silent and unable to speak until the day these things happen." |
| <p>21 <i>And the people waited for Zacharias, and marvelled that he tarried so long in the temple.</i></p> | The people were waiting for Zacharias and wondered why he was taking so long in the temple. |

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| <p>22 <i>And when he came out, he could not speak unto them: and they perceived that he had seen a vision in the temple: for he beckoned unto them, and remained speechless.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And it came to pass, that, as soon as the days of his ministration were accomplished, he departed to his own house.</i></p> <p>24 <i>And after those days his wife Elisabeth conceived, and hid herself five months, saying,</i></p> <p>25 <i>Thus hath the Lord dealt with me in the days wherein he looked on me, to take away my reproach among men.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent from God unto a city of Galilee, named Nazareth,</i></p> <p>27 <i>To a virgin espoused to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David; and the virgin's name was Mary.</i></p> | <p>When he came out, he could not speak to them. They realized he had seen a vision in the temple. He kept making signs to them and remained unable to speak.</p> <p>When the days of his service were completed, he went home.</p> <p>After those days his wife Elisabeth conceived, and she kept herself in seclusion for five months. She said,</p> <p>"This is what the Lord has done for me in the days when He looked on me, to take away my disgrace among people."</p> <p>In the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent from God to a city of Galilee called Nazareth,</p> <p>to a virgin engaged to a man named Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin's name was Mary.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mary** (MAIR-ee) — from the Hebrew Miriam, meaning "bitterness" or "beloved" — The virgin mother of Jesus Christ, chosen by God to bear the Son of God.

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| <p>28 <i>And the angel came in unto her, and said, Hail, thou that art highly favoured, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and cast in her mind what manner of salutation this should be.</i></p> | <p>The angel came to her and said, "Greetings, you who are highly favored! The Lord is with You. You are blessed among women."</p> <p>She was troubled at His words and wondered what kind of greeting this could be.</p> |
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- 30 *And the angel said unto her, Fear not, Mary: for thou hast found favour with God.* The angel said to her, "Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn. "Favour" and "grace" translate the same Greek word (charis). Grace is God giving us what we do not deserve.*

- 31 *And, behold, thou shalt conceive in thy womb, and bring forth a son, and shalt call his name JESUS.* You will conceive in your womb and give birth to a son, and you shall call His name JESUS.
- 32 *He shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest: and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David:* He will be great and will be called the Son of the Highest. The Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David.
- 33 *And he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever; and of his kingdom there shall be no end.* He will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and his kingdom will have no end."
- 34 *Then said Mary unto the angel, How shall this be, seeing I know not a man?* Mary said to the angel, "How will this be, since I have not known a man?"
- 35 *And the angel answered and said unto her, The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shall overshadow thee: therefore also that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God.* The angel answered her, "The Holy Ghost will come upon You, and the power of the Highest will overshadow You. Therefore also that holy thing which shall be born of You will be called the Son of God.
- 36 *And, behold, thy cousin Elisabeth, she hath also conceived a son in her old age: and this is the sixth month with her, who was called barren.* Your cousin Elisabeth has also conceived a son in her old age. This is the sixth month for her who was called barren.
- 37 *For with God nothing shall be impossible.* For nothing is impossible with God."

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| <p>38 <i>And Mary said, Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word. And the angel departed from her.</i></p> | <p>Mary said, "I am the servant of the Lord. Let it be to me according to your word." And the angel departed from her.</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And Mary arose in those days, and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Juda;</i></p> | <p>In those days Mary arose and went quickly into the hill country, to a city of Judah.</p> |
| <p>40 <i>And entered into the house of Zacharias, and saluted Elisabeth.</i></p> | <p>She entered the house of Zacharias and greeted Elisabeth.</p> |
| <p>41 <i>And it came to pass, that, when Elisabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb; and Elisabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost:</i></p> | <p>When Elisabeth heard Mary's greeting, the baby leaped in her womb. Elisabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost.</p> |
| <p>42 <i>And she spake out with a loud voice, and said, Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb.</i></p> | <p>She cried out with a loud voice and said, "Blessed are You among women, and blessed is the fruit of Your womb!</p> |
| <p>43 <i>And whence is this to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?</i></p> | <p>Why is this granted to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?</p> |
| <p>44 <i>For, lo, as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in mine ears, the babe leaped in my womb for joy.</i></p> | <p>The moment Your greeting reached my ears, the baby in my womb leaped for joy.</p> |
| <p>45 <i>And blessed is she that believed: for there shall be a performance of those things which were told her from the Lord.</i></p> | <p>Blessed is she who believed, for there will be a fulfillment of what was spoken to her from the Lord."</p> |
| <p>46 <i>And Mary said, My soul doth magnify the Lord,</i></p> | <p>Mary said, "My soul magnifies the Lord,</p> |
| <p>47 <i>And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour.</i></p> | <p>and my spirit has rejoiced in God my Savior.</p> |

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| <p>48 <i>For he hath regarded the low estate of his handmaiden: for, behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed.</i></p> | <p>For He has looked on the humble condition of His servant. From now on all generations will call me blessed.</p> |
| <p>49 <i>For he that is mighty hath done to me great things; and holy is his name.</i></p> | <p>He who is mighty has done great things for me, and holy is His name.</p> |
| <p>50 <i>And his mercy is on them that fear him from generation to generation.</i></p> | <p>His mercy is on those who fear Him from generation to generation.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — *Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. Mercy is not getting what we deserve.*

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| <p>51 <i>He hath shewed strength with his arm; he hath scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.</i></p> | <p>He has shown strength with His arm.
He has scattered the proud in the thoughts of their hearts.</p> |
| <p>52 <i>He hath put down the mighty from their seats, and exalted them of low degree.</i></p> | <p>He has brought down the mighty from their thrones and lifted up the lowly.</p> |
| <p>53 <i>He hath filled the hungry with good things; and the rich he hath sent empty away.</i></p> | <p>He has filled the hungry with good things, and the rich He has sent away empty.</p> |
| <p>54 <i>He hath holpen his servant Israel, in remembrance of his mercy;</i></p> | <p>He has helped His servant Israel, in remembrance of his mercy,</p> |
| <p>55 <i>As he spake to our fathers, to Abraham, and to his seed for ever.</i></p> | <p>as He spoke to our fathers, to Abraham and to his descendants forever."</p> |
| <p>56 <i>And Mary abode with her about three months, and returned to her own house.</i></p> | <p>Mary stayed with her about three months and then returned to her own home.</p> |
| <p>57 <i>Now Elisabeth's full time came that she should be delivered; and she brought forth a son.</i></p> | <p>When the time came for Elisabeth to give birth, she had a son.</p> |

- 58 *And her neighbours and her cousins heard how the Lord had shewed great mercy upon her; and they rejoiced with her.* Her neighbors and relatives heard that the Lord had shown great mercy to her, and they rejoiced with her.
- 59 *And it came to pass, that on the eighth day they came to circumcise the child; and they called him Zacharias, after the name of his father.* On the eighth day they came to circumcise the child, and they were going to name him Zacharias after his father.
- 60 *And his mother answered and said, Not so; but he shall be called John.* His mother said, "No — he shall be called John."
- 61 *And they said unto her, There is none of thy kindred that is called by this name.* They said to her, "None of your family is called by that name."
- 62 *And they made signs to his father, how he would have him called.* They made signs to his father, asking what he wanted the child to be called.
- 63 *And he asked for a writing table, and wrote, saying, His name is John. And they marvelled all.* He asked for a writing tablet and wrote, "His name is John." They were all amazed.
- 64 *And his mouth was opened immediately, and his tongue loosed, and he spake, and praised God.* Immediately his mouth was opened and his tongue was freed, and he spoke and praised God.
- 65 *And fear came on all that dwelt round about them: and all these sayings were noised abroad throughout all the hill country of Judaea.* Fear came on all who lived around them, and all these things were talked about throughout all the hill country of Judaea.
- 66 *And all they that heard them laid them up in their hearts, saying, What manner of child shall this be! And the hand of the Lord was with him.* All who heard these things kept them in their hearts and said, "What then will this child be?" For the hand of the Lord was with Him.
- 67 *And his father Zacharias was filled with the Holy Ghost, and prophesied, saying,* His father Zacharias was filled with the Holy Ghost and prophesied, saying,

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| 68 <i>Blessed be the Lord God of Israel; for he hath visited and redeemed his people,</i> | "Blessed be the Lord God of Israel, for He has visited and redeemed His people. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (rih-DEMP-shun) — *To buy back; to set free by paying a price. God redeemed His people by sending Christ to pay the price for sin that we could never pay ourselves.*

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| 69 <i>And hath raised up an horn of salvation for us in the house of his servant David;</i> | He has raised up a horn of salvation for us in the house of His servant David, |
| 70 <i>As he spake by the mouth of his holy prophets, which have been since the world began:</i> | as He spoke by the mouth of His holy prophets from long ago: |
| 71 <i>That we should be saved from our enemies, and from the hand of all that hate us;</i> | salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all who hate us; |
| 72 <i>To perform the mercy promised to our fathers, and to remember his holy covenant;</i> | to show the mercy promised to our fathers and to remember His holy covenant, |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — *A binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. God's covenants are not mere contracts — they are His sworn, unbreakable commitments.*

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| 73 <i>The oath which he sware to our father Abraham,</i> | the oath He swore to our father Abraham: |
| 74 <i>That he would grant unto us, that we being delivered out of the hand of our enemies might serve him without fear,</i> | to grant us that we, being rescued from the hand of our enemies, might serve Him without fear, |
| 75 <i>In holiness and righteousness before him, all the days of our life.</i> | in holiness and righteousness before Him all the days of our lives. |
| 76 <i>And thou, child, shalt be called the prophet of the Highest: for thou shalt go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways;</i> | And you, child, will be called the prophet of the Highest, for you will go before the Lord to prepare His ways, |

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| 77 | <i>To give knowledge of salvation unto his people by the remission of their sins,</i> | to give His people knowledge of salvation through the forgiveness of their sins, |
| 78 | <i>Through the tender mercy of our God; whereby the dayspring from on high hath visited us,</i> | through the tender mercy of our God, by which the dayspring from on high has visited us, |
| 79 | <i>To give light to them that sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the way of peace.</i> | to give light to those who sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the way of peace." |
| 80 | <i>And the child grew, and waxed strong in spirit, and was in the deserts till the day of his shewing unto Israel.</i> | The child grew and grew strong in spirit, and he was in the wilderness until the day he was presented to Israel. |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

dayspring — The dawn or rising sun — used poetically in Job 38:12 and Luke 1:78 to describe God's arrival bringing light after darkness.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Elisabeth (*eh-LIZ-ah-beth*) — The mother of John the Baptist, wife of Zacharias, and a relative of Mary — her name means 'God is my oath.'

Herod (*HEHR-od*) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.

Cross-References:

- v13** — 1 Sam 2:21; Acts 10:31; Ps 113:9; Gen 25:21; Ps 127:3-5
- v17** — Mal 4:5-6; Matt 11:14; Luke 1:76; John 1:21-30; Mark 9:11-13
- v28** — Judg 6:12; Dan 10:19; Luke 1:30; Eph 1:6; Dan 9:21-23
- v31** — Isa 7:14; Matt 1:21; Matt 1:25; Luke 2:21; Matt 1:23
- v32** — Isa 9:6-7; Isa 16:5; 2 Sam 7:11-13; Luke 1:35; Ps 132:11

v33 — Dan 2:44; Heb 1:8; Dan 7:13-14; Dan 7:27; Ps 89:35-37
 v37 — Matt 19:26; Jer 32:27; Mark 10:27; Jer 32:17; Luke 18:27
 v45 — John 20:29; John 11:40; Luke 11:27-28; Luke 1:20; 2 Chr 20:20
 v46 — 1 Sam 2:1-10; Ps 34:2-3; Ps 35:9; Isa 61:10; Ps 103:1-2
 v49 — Eph 3:20; Ps 126:2-3; Ps 111:9; Ps 99:3; Gen 17:1
 v50 — Ps 103:17-18; Ex 20:6; Gen 17:7; Ex 34:6-7; Ps 118:4
 v79 — Isa 9:2; Acts 26:18; Matt 4:16; Isa 42:7; Eph 5:8

Chapter 2

Caesar Augustus decrees a census, and Joseph and Mary travel to Bethlehem, where Jesus is born and laid in a manger. Angels appear to shepherds in the fields announcing the Saviour's birth. Jesus is presented at the temple, where Simeon and Anna prophesy over Him.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass in those days, that there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus, that all the world should be taxed.</i> | In those days a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that all the world should be registered. |
| 2 | <i>(And this taxing was first made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria.)</i> | This was the first registration, made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria. |
| 3 | <i>And all went to be taxed, every one into his own city.</i> | Everyone went to be registered, each to His own city. |
| 4 | <i>And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judaea, unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem; (because he was of the house and lineage of David:)</i> | Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judaea, to the city of David called Bethlehem, because he was of the house and family of David. |
| 5 | <i>To be taxed with Mary his espoused wife, being great with child.</i> | He went to be registered with Mary, his promised wife, who was expecting a child. |
| 6 | <i>And so it was, that, while they were there, the days were accomplished that she should be delivered.</i> | While they were there, the time came for her to give birth. |

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| 7 <i>And she brought forth her firstborn son, and wrapped him in swaddling clothes, and laid him in a manger; because there was no room for them in the inn.</i> | She gave birth to her firstborn son. She wrapped Him in cloths and laid Him in a manger, because there was no room for them at the inn. |
| 8 <i>And there were in the same country shepherds abiding in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night.</i> | In that region there were shepherds staying in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night. |
| 9 <i>And, lo, the angel of the Lord came upon them, and the glory of the Lord shone round about them: and they were sore afraid.</i> | An angel of the Lord appeared to them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they were greatly afraid. |
| 10 <i>And the angel said unto them, Fear not: for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy, which shall be to all people.</i> | The angel said to them, "Do not be afraid, for I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all people. |
| 11 <i>For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.</i> | For to You is born this day in the city of David a Savior, who is Christ the Lord. |
| 12 <i>And this shall be a sign unto you; Ye shall find the babe wrapped in swaddling clothes, lying in a manger.</i> | This will be a sign to You: You will find the baby wrapped in cloths and lying in a manger." |
| 13 <i>And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host praising God, and saying,</i> | Suddenly there was with the angel a great crowd of the heavenly host praising God and saying, |
| 14 <i>Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will toward men.</i> | "Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will toward men." |

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| <p>15 <i>And it came to pass, as the angels were gone away from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another, Let us now go even unto Bethlehem, and see this thing which is come to pass, which the Lord hath made known unto us.</i></p> | <p>When the angels had gone away into heaven, the shepherds said to one another, "Let us go to Bethlehem and see this thing that has happened, which the Lord has made known to us."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And they came with haste, and found Mary, and Joseph, and the babe lying in a manger.</i></p> | <p>They went quickly and found Mary and Joseph, and the baby lying in a manger.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And when they had seen it, they made known abroad the saying which was told them concerning this child.</i></p> | <p>When they had seen Him, they spread the word about what they had been told concerning this child.</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And all they that heard it wondered at those things which were told them by the shepherds.</i></p> | <p>All who heard it were amazed at what the shepherds told them.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>But Mary kept all these things, and pondered them in her heart.</i></p> | <p>But Mary kept all these things and pondered them in her heart.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things that they had heard and seen, as it was told unto them.</i></p> | <p>The shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all they had heard and seen, just as it had been told to them.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>And when eight days were accomplished for the circumcising of the child, his name was called JESUS, which was so named of the angel before he was conceived in the womb.</i></p> | <p>When eight days had passed for the circumcision of the child, he was named JESUS, the name given by the angel before he was conceived in the womb.</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And when the days of her purification according to the law of Moses were accomplished, they brought him to Jerusalem, to present him to the Lord;</i></p> | <p>When the days of her purification according to the law of Moses were completed, they brought him to Jerusalem to present Him to the Lord,</p> |
| <p>23 <i>(As it is written in the law of the Lord, Every male that openeth the womb shall be called holy to the Lord;)</i></p> | <p>as it is written in the law of the Lord: "Every male who opens the womb shall be called holy to the Lord."</p> |

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| <p>24 <i>And to offer a sacrifice according to that which is said in the law of the Lord, A pair of turtledoves, or two young pigeons.</i></p> | <p>They also came to offer a sacrifice as stated in the law of the Lord: a pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons.</p> |
| <p>25 <i>And, behold, there was a man in Jerusalem, whose name was Simeon; and the same man was just and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel: and the Holy Ghost was upon him.</i></p> | <p>There was a man in Jerusalem whose name was Simeon. He was righteous and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Ghost was upon Him.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Simeon** (SIM-ee-un) — "heard" or "he who hears" — A righteous and devout man in Jerusalem who had been promised by the Holy Ghost that he would not die before seeing the Christ.

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| <p>26 <i>And it was revealed unto him by the Holy Ghost, that he should not see death, before he had seen the Lord's Christ.</i></p> | <p>It had been revealed to Him by the Holy Ghost that He would not see death before He had seen the Lord's Christ.</p> |
| <p>27 <i>And he came by the Spirit into the temple: and when the parents brought in the child Jesus, to do for him after the custom of the law,</i></p> | <p>He came by the Spirit into the temple. When the parents brought in the child Jesus to do for Him what the law required,</p> |
| <p>28 <i>Then took he him up in his arms, and blessed God, and said,</i></p> | <p>Simeon took Him up in His arms and blessed God and said,</p> |
| <p>29 <i>Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace, according to thy word:</i></p> | <p>"Lord, now You are letting Your servant depart in peace, according to Your word;</p> |
| <p>30 <i>For mine eyes have seen thy salvation,</i></p> | <p>for my eyes have seen Your salvation,</p> |
| <p>31 <i>Which thou hast prepared before the face of all people;</i></p> | <p>which You have prepared before all people —</p> |
| <p>32 <i>A light to lighten the Gentiles, and the glory of thy people Israel.</i></p> | <p>a light for revelation to the Gentiles and the glory of Your people Israel."</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And Joseph and his mother marvelled at those things which were spoken of him.</i></p> | <p>Joseph and his mother marveled at what was said about Him.</p> |

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| <p>34 <i>And Simeon blessed them, and said unto Mary his mother, Behold, this child is set for the fall and rising again of many in Israel; and for a sign which shall be spoken against;</i></p> | <p>Simeon blessed them and said to Mary his mother, "This child is appointed for the fall and rising of many in Israel, and for a sign that will be spoken against —</p> |
| <p>35 <i>(Yea, a sword shall pierce through thy own soul also,) that the thoughts of many hearts may be revealed.</i></p> | <p>and a sword will pierce through your own soul too — so that the thoughts of many hearts may be revealed."</p> |
| <p>36 <i>And there was one Anna, a prophetess, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Aser: she was of a great age, and had lived with an husband seven years from her virginity;</i></p> | <p>There was also a prophetess, Anna, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was very old. She had lived with her husband seven years from her marriage,</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — *Anna* (AN-uh) — "grace" or "favor" — A prophetess of great age who never left the temple, serving God with fasting and prayer night and day.

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| <p>37 <i>And she was a widow of about fourscore and four years, which departed not from the temple, but served God with fastings and prayers night and day.</i></p> | <p>and she was a widow of about eighty-four years. She never left the temple but served God with fasting and prayer night and day.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And she coming in that instant gave thanks likewise unto the Lord, and spake of him to all them that looked for redemption in Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Coming up at that very moment, she gave thanks to the Lord and spoke about Him to all who were looking for the redemption of Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And when they had performed all things according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their own city Nazareth.</i></p> | <p>When they had done everything required by the law of the Lord, they returned to Galilee, to their own city of Nazareth.</p> |
| <p>40 <i>And the child grew, and waxed strong in spirit, filled with wisdom: and the grace of God was upon him.</i></p> | <p>The child grew and grew strong, filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was upon Him.</p> |
| <p>41 <i>Now his parents went to Jerusalem every year at the feast of the passover.</i></p> | <p>His parents went to Jerusalem every year for the feast of the Passover.</p> |

- 42 *And when he was twelve years old, they went up to Jerusalem after the custom of the feast.* When He was twelve years old, they went up according to the custom of the feast.
- 43 *And when they had fulfilled the days, as they returned, the child Jesus tarried behind in Jerusalem; and Joseph and his mother knew not of it.* When the days were over and they were returning home, the boy Jesus stayed behind in Jerusalem. His parents did not know it.
- 44 *But they, supposing him to have been in the company, went a day's journey; and they sought him among their kinsfolk and acquaintance.* Thinking He was in the traveling group, they went a day's journey. Then they began looking for Him among their relatives and friends.
- 45 *And when they found him not, they turned back again to Jerusalem, seeking him.* When they did not find Him, they returned to Jerusalem, searching for Him.
- 46 *And it came to pass, that after three days they found him in the temple, sitting in the midst of the doctors, both hearing them, and asking them questions.* After three days they found Him in the temple, sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions.
- 47 *And all that heard him were astonished at his understanding and answers.* All who heard Him were astonished at His understanding and His answers.
- 48 *And when they saw him, they were amazed: and his mother said unto him, Son, why hast thou thus dealt with us? behold, thy father and I have sought thee sorrowing.* When they saw Him, they were amazed. His mother said to Him, "Son, why have You treated us like this? Your father and I have been searching for You with great anxiety."
- 49 *And he said unto them, How is it that ye sought me? wist ye not that I must be about my Father's business?* He said to them, "Why were You searching for Me? Did You not know that I must be about My Father's business?"
- 50 *And they understood not the saying which he spake unto them.* But they did not understand what He said to them.

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| 51 | <i>And he went down with them, and came to Nazareth, and was subject unto them: but his mother kept all these sayings in her heart.</i> | He went down with them and came to Nazareth and was obedient to them. His mother kept all these things in her heart. |
| 52 | <i>And Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and man.</i> | Jesus grew in wisdom and in stature, and in favor with God and man. |
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Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Asher (*ASH-er*) — Jacob's eighth son, by Zilpah — his tribe settled in the fertile coastal region of northern Canaan; his name means 'happy' or 'blessed.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v7 — Gal 4:4; 2 Cor 8:9; John 1:14; Isa 53:2-3; Matt 1:25
- v10 — Isa 40:9; Isa 61:1; Isa 52:7; Gen 12:3; Matt 28:18
- v11 — Isa 9:6; Matt 1:21; Titus 3:4-7; Acts 2:36; Matt 16:16
- v14 — Rom 5:1; Luke 19:38; Luke 1:79; Col 1:20; Heb 13:20-21
- v23 — Ex 13:2; Num 3:13; Ex 22:29; Num 18:15; Ex 34:19
- v25 — Isa 25:9; Luke 1:6; Luke 2:38; Titus 2:11-14; Mark 15:43
- v32 — Isa 60:1-3; Isa 49:6; Acts 26:23; Acts 13:47-48; Isa 42:6-7
- v34 — 1 Cor 1:23; 1 Pet 2:7-8; Isa 8:14-15; Matt 21:44; 2 Cor 2:15-16
- v37 — 1 Tim 5:5; Ps 23:6; Acts 14:23; Ps 27:4; Acts 13:3
- v40 — Luke 2:52; Luke 1:80; Isa 11:1-5; John 1:14; 1 Sam 2:26
- v49 — John 6:38; John 8:29; Mal 3:1; Ps 40:8; John 4:34
- v52 — Luke 2:40; Prov 3:3-4; 1 Sam 2:26; Rom 14:18; Luke 1:80

Chapter 3

John the Baptist preaches repentance and baptizes in the Jordan, warning the crowds to bring forth fruits worthy of repentance. Jesus is baptized, the Holy Ghost descends on Him like a dove, and the Father's voice declares Him His beloved Son. Luke traces Jesus's genealogy from Joseph back through David and Abraham to Adam.

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| <p>1 <i>Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being governor of Judaea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and his brother Philip tetrarch of Ituraea and of the region of Trachonitis, and Lysanias the tetrarch of Abilene,</i></p> | <p>In the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, when Pontius Pilate was governor of Judaea, Herod tetrarch of Galilee, his brother Philip tetrarch of Ituraea and the region of Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilene,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Annas and Caiaphas being the high priests, the word of God came unto John the son of Zacharias in the wilderness.</i></p> | <p>during the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, the word of God came to John the son of Zacharias in the wilderness.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he came into all the country about Jordan, preaching the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins;</i></p> | <p>He went into all the region around the Jordan, preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>As it is written in the book of the words of Esaias the prophet, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.</i></p> | <p>This is as it is written in the book of the words of Isaiah the prophet: "The voice of one crying in the wilderness: Prepare the way of the Lord, make His paths straight.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Every valley shall be filled, and every mountain and hill shall be brought low; and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough ways shall be made smooth;</i></p> | <p>Every valley shall be filled, and every mountain and hill shall be brought low. The crooked shall be made straight, and the rough ways smooth.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And all flesh shall see the salvation of God.</i></p> | <p>All flesh shall see the salvation of God."</p> |

- 7 *Then said he to the multitude that came forth to be baptized of him, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?* He said to the crowds that came out to be baptized by him, "You generation of vipers! Who warned you to flee from the wrath to come?"
- 8 *Bring forth therefore fruits worthy of repentance, and begin not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, That God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.* Produce fruit in keeping with repentance, and do not start saying to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' For I tell you, God is able to raise up children for Abraham from these stones.
- 9 *And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: every tree therefore which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.* Even now the axe is laid to the root of the trees. Every tree that does not produce good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire."
- 10 *And the people asked him, saying, What shall we do then?* The people asked him, "What shall we do then?"
- 11 *He answereth and saith unto them, He that hath two coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.* He answered them, "Whoever has two coats, let him share with the one who has none. Whoever has food, let him do likewise."
- 12 *Then came also publicans to be baptized, and said unto him, Master, what shall we do?* Tax collectors also came to be baptized and said to him, "Master, what shall we do?"
- 13 *And he said unto them, Exact no more than that which is appointed you.* He said to them, "Collect no more than you are authorized to collect."
- 14 *And the soldiers likewise demanded of him, saying, And what shall we do? And he said unto them, Do violence to no man, neither accuse any falsely; and be content with your wages.* Soldiers also asked him, "And what about us — what shall we do?" He said to them, "Do not extort money from anyone by force, and do not make false accusations. Be content with your wages."

- 15 *And as the people were in expectation, and all men mused in their hearts of John, whether he were the Christ, or not;* The people were in a state of expectation, and everyone was wondering in their hearts whether John might be the Christ.
- 16 *John answered, saying unto them all, I indeed baptize you with water; but one mightier than I cometh, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to unloose: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire:* John answered them all, "I baptize you with water. But One mightier than I is coming, the strap of whose sandals I am not worthy to loosen. He will baptize You with the Holy Ghost and with fire.
- 17 *Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and will gather the wheat into his garner; but the chaff he will burn with fire unquenchable.* His winnowing fork is in His hand, and He will thoroughly clear His threshing floor. He will gather the wheat into His barn, but the chaff He will burn with unquenchable fire."
- 18 *And many other things in his exhortation preached he unto the people.* With many other exhortations He preached the good news to the people.
- 19 *But Herod the tetrarch, being reproved by him for Herodias his brother Philip's wife, and for all the evils which Herod had done,* But Herod the tetrarch, being rebuked by John for Herodias his brother Philip's wife and for all the evil things Herod had done,
- 20 *Added yet this above all, that he shut up John in prison.* added to it all by shutting John up in prison.
- 21 *Now when all the people were baptized, it came to pass, that Jesus also being baptized, and praying, the heaven was opened,* When all the people were baptized, Jesus also was baptized. As He was praying, heaven was opened,
- 22 *And the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape like a dove upon him, and a voice came from heaven, which said, Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.* and the Holy Ghost descended on Him in bodily form like a dove. A voice came from heaven: "You are My beloved Son; in You I am well pleased."

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| 23 | <i>And Jesus himself began to be about thirty years of age, being (as was supposed) the son of Joseph, which was the son of Heli,</i> | Jesus Himself was about thirty years old when He began His ministry. He was the son (as was supposed) of Joseph, the son of Heli, |
| 24 | <i>Which was the son of Matthat, which was the son of Levi, which was the son of Melchi, which was the son of Janna, which was the son of Joseph,</i> | the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, the son of Melchi, the son of Janna, the son of Joseph, |
| 25 | <i>Which was the son of Mattathias, which was the son of Amos, which was the son of Naum, which was the son of Esli, which was the son of Nagge,</i> | the son of Mattathias, the son of Amos, the son of Naum, the son of Esli, the son of Nagge, |
| 26 | <i>Which was the son of Maath, which was the son of Mattathias, which was the son of Semei, which was the son of Joseph, which was the son of Juda,</i> | the son of Maath, the son of Mattathias, the son of Semei, the son of Joseph, the son of Juda, |
| 27 | <i>Which was the son of Joanna, which was the son of Rhesa, which was the son of Zorobabel, which was the son of Salathiel, which was the son of Neri,</i> | the son of Joanna, the son of Rhesa, the son of Zorobabel, the son of Salathiel, the son of Neri, |
| 28 | <i>Which was the son of Melchi, which was the son of Addi, which was the son of Cosam, which was the son of Elmodam, which was the son of Er,</i> | the son of Melchi, the son of Addi, the son of Cosam, the son of Elmodam, the son of Er, |
| 29 | <i>Which was the son of Jose, which was the son of Eliezer, which was the son of Jorim, which was the son of Matthat, which was the son of Levi,</i> | the son of Jose, the son of Eliezer, the son of Jorim, the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, |
| 30 | <i>Which was the son of Simeon, which was the son of Juda, which was the son of Joseph, which was the son of Jonan, which was the son of Eliakim,</i> | the son of Simeon, the son of Juda, the son of Joseph, the son of Jonan, the son of Eliakim, |

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| 31 | <p><i>Which was the son of Melea, which was the son of Menan, which was the son of Mattatha, which was the son of Nathan, which was the son of David,</i></p> | <p>the son of Melea, the son of Menan, the son of Mattatha, the son of Nathan, the son of David,</p> |
| 32 | <p><i>Which was the son of Jesse, which was the son of Obed, which was the son of Booz, which was the son of Salmon, which was the son of Naasson,</i></p> | <p>the son of Jesse, the son of Obed, the son of Booz, the son of Salmon, the son of Naasson,</p> |
| 33 | <p><i>Which was the son of Aminadab, which was the son of Aram, which was the son of Esrom, which was the son of Phares, which was the son of Juda,</i></p> | <p>the son of Aminadab, the son of Aram, the son of Esrom, the son of Phares, the son of Juda,</p> |
| 34 | <p><i>Which was the son of Jacob, which was the son of Isaac, which was the son of Abraham, which was the son of Thara, which was the son of Nachor,</i></p> | <p>the son of Jacob, the son of Isaac, the son of Abraham, the son of Thara, the son of Nachor,</p> |
| 35 | <p><i>Which was the son of Saruch, which was the son of Ragau, which was the son of Phalec, which was the son of Heber, which was the son of Sala,</i></p> | <p>the son of Saruch, the son of Ragau, the son of Phalec, the son of Heber, the son of Sala,</p> |
| 36 | <p><i>Which was the son of Cainan, which was the son of Arphaxad, which was the son of Sem, which was the son of Noe, which was the son of Lamech,</i></p> | <p>the son of Cainan, the son of Arphaxad, the son of Sem, the son of Noe, the son of Lamech,</p> |
| 37 | <p><i>Which was the son of Mathusala, which was the son of Enoch, which was the son of Jared, which was the son of Maleleel, which was the son of Cainan,</i></p> | <p>the son of Mathusala, the son of Enoch, the son of Jared, the son of Maleleel, the son of Cainan,</p> |
| 38 | <p><i>Which was the son of Enos, which was the son of Seth, which was the son of Adam, which was the son of God.</i></p> | <p>the son of Enos, the son of Seth, the son of Adam, the son of God.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Caiaphas (*KY-ah-fas*) — The Jewish high priest during Jesus's trial — he declared it better for one man to die for the nation; he unwittingly prophesied Christ's death for all people.

Enoch (*EE-nok*) — A man who 'walked with God' — he did not die but was taken by God; ancestor of Noah; father of Methuselah.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Luke 23:6-11; Luke 9:7; Luke 2:1; Gen 49:10; Luke 23:24

v2 — Acts 4:6; Jonah 1:1; Luke 1:80; John 18:24; Matt 26:3

v4 — Isa 40:3-5; John 1:23; Luke 1:76-79; John 1:7; John 1:26-36

v5 — Isa 40:4; Isa 42:16; Isa 45:2; Isa 49:11; Ezek 17:24

v6 — Isa 52:10; Isa 40:5; Ps 98:2-3; Isa 49:6; Rom 10:18

v8 — Ezek 18:27-31; Acts 26:20; Isa 1:16-18; Matt 21:43; Gal 5:22-24

v9 — Matt 7:19; John 15:6; Luke 13:9

v11 — Isa 58:7-11; 1 John 3:17; 1 Tim 6:18; Luke 18:22; 1 John 4:20

v14 — Heb 13:5-6; Ex 20:16; Ex 23:1; 1 Tim 6:8-10; Phil 4:11

v16 — Matt 3:11; Acts 1:5; Acts 11:15-16; John 1:33; Acts 19:4-5

v17 — Matt 13:30; Jer 15:7; Mic 4:12; Ps 1:4; Isa 30:24

v22 — Ps 2:7; 2 Pet 1:17-18; John 1:32; Isa 42:1; Matt 17:5

Chapter 4

Jesus, full of the Holy Ghost, is tempted by the devil in the wilderness for forty days and overcomes every temptation with Scripture. He reads from Isaiah in the synagogue at Nazareth and declares the prophecy fulfilled, but the people of His hometown reject Him and try to throw Him off a cliff. He casts out demons and heals the sick in Capernaum.

- ¹ *And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost* Jesus, full of the Holy Ghost, returned
returned from Jordan, and was led by from the Jordan and was led by the
the Spirit into the wilderness, Spirit into the wilderness,

- 2 *Being forty days tempted of the devil. And in those days he did eat nothing: and when they were ended, he afterward hungered.* where He was tempted by the devil for forty days. He ate nothing during those days, and when they were over He was hungry.
- 3 *And the devil said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, command this stone that it be made bread.* The devil said to him, "If you are the Son of God, command this stone to become bread."
- 4 *And Jesus answered him, saying, It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.* Jesus answered Him, "It is written: 'Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.'"
- 5 *And the devil, taking him up into an high mountain, shewed unto him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time.* The devil took him up to a high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time.
- 6 *And the devil said unto him, All this power will I give thee, and the glory of them: for that is delivered unto me; and to whomsoever I will I give it.* The devil said to him, "I will give you all this power and their glory, for it has been handed over to me, and I give it to whoever I wish.
- 7 *If thou therefore wilt worship me, all shall be thine.* If You therefore worship me, all of it will be Yours."
- 8 *And Jesus answered and said unto him, Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.* Jesus answered Him, "Get behind Me, Satan! For it is written: 'You shall worship the Lord Your God, and Him only shall You serve.'"
- 9 *And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down from hence:* He brought Him to Jerusalem, set Him on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to Him, "If You are the Son of God, throw Yourself down from here.
- 10 *For it is written, He shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee:* For it is written: 'He will give His angels charge over You, to guard You,'

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| <p>11 <i>And in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.</i></p> | <p>and 'in their hands they will lift You up, lest You strike Your foot against a stone.'"</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And Jesus answering said unto him, It is said, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.</i></p> | <p>Jesus answered Him, "It is said: 'You shall not tempt the Lord Your God.'"</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And when the devil had ended all the temptation, he departed from him for a season.</i></p> | <p>When the devil had finished every temptation, he departed from Him until an opportune time.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And Jesus returned in the power of the Spirit into Galilee: and there went out a fame of him through all the region round about.</i></p> | <p>Jesus returned in the power of the Spirit to Galilee, and news about Him spread through all the surrounding region.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And he taught in their synagogues, being glorified of all.</i></p> | <p>He taught in their synagogues, and everyone praised Him.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And he came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up: and, as his custom was, he went into the synagogue on the sabbath day, and stood up for to read.</i></p> | <p>He came to Nazareth, where He had been brought up. On the Sabbath day He went into the synagogue, as was His custom, and stood up to read.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And there was delivered unto him the book of the prophet Esaias. And when he had opened the book, he found the place where it was written,</i></p> | <p>The scroll of the prophet Isaiah was handed to him. He opened the scroll and found the place where it was written:</p> |
| <p>18 <i>The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor; he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised,</i></p> | <p>"The Spirit of the Lord is upon Me, because He has anointed Me to preach the gospel to the poor. He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to set at liberty those who are oppressed,</p> |
| <p>19 <i>To preach the acceptable year of the Lord.</i></p> | <p>to preach the acceptable year of the Lord."</p> |

- 20 *And he closed the book, and he gave it again to the minister, and sat down. And the eyes of all them that were in the synagogue were fastened on him.* He closed the scroll, gave it back to the attendant, and sat down. The eyes of everyone in the synagogue were fixed on Him.
- 21 *And he began to say unto them, This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears.* He began to say to them, "Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing."
- 22 *And all bare him witness, and wondered at the gracious words which proceeded out of his mouth. And they said, Is not this Joseph's son?* All spoke well of Him and were amazed at the gracious words coming from His mouth. They said, "Is this not Joseph's son?"
- 23 *And he said unto them, Ye will surely say unto me this proverb, Physician, heal thyself: whatsoever we have heard done in Capernaum, do also here in thy country.* He said to them, "You will certainly quote this proverb to Me: 'Physician, heal yourself.' Do here in your hometown what we have heard You did in Capernaum."
- 24 *And he said, Verily I say unto you, No prophet is accepted in his own country.* He said, "Truly I tell you, no prophet is accepted in his hometown.
- 25 *But I tell you of a truth, many widows were in Israel in the days of Elias, when the heaven was shut up three years and six months, when great famine was throughout all the land;* But truly I tell you, there were many widows in Israel in the days of Elijah, when the sky was shut up for three years and six months, and great famine came over all the land.
- 26 *But unto none of them was Elias sent, save unto Sarepta, a city of Sidon, unto a woman that was a widow.* Yet Elijah was sent to none of them — only to Zarephath, a city of Sidon, to a woman who was a widow.
- 27 *And many lepers were in Israel in the time of Eliseus the prophet; and none of them was cleansed, saving Naaman the Syrian.* There were also many lepers in Israel in the time of Elisha the prophet, and none of them was cleansed — only Naaman the Syrian."

- 28 *And all they in the synagogue, when they heard these things, were filled with wrath,* All in the synagogue were filled with fury when they heard these things.
- 29 *And rose up, and thrust him out of the city, and led him unto the brow of the hill whereon their city was built, that they might cast him down headlong.* They rose up, drove Him out of the city, and led Him to the brow of the hill on which their city was built, intending to throw Him off the cliff.
- 30 *But he passing through the midst of them went his way.* But He passed through the midst of them and went on His way.
- 31 *And came down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and taught them on the sabbath days.* He went down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and was teaching them on the Sabbath days.
- 32 *And they were astonished at his doctrine: for his word was with power.* They were astonished at His teaching, for His word was with authority.
- 33 *And in the synagogue there was a man, which had a spirit of an unclean devil, and cried out with a loud voice,* In the synagogue there was a man who had a spirit of an unclean devil, and he cried out with a loud voice,
- 34 *Saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art; the Holy One of God.* "Leave us alone! What do You want with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have You come to destroy us? I know who You are — the Holy One of God."
- 35 *And Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him. And when the devil had thrown him in the midst, he came out of him, and hurt him not.* Jesus rebuked Him and said, "Be silent, and come out of Him!" The devil threw the man down in the middle of the crowd and came out of Him without hurting Him.
- 36 *And they were all amazed, and spake among themselves, saying, What a word is this! for with authority and power he commandeth the unclean spirits, and they come out.* They were all amazed and said to one another, "What kind of word is this? With authority and power He commands the unclean spirits, and they come out!"

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| 37 <i>And the fame of him went out into every place of the country round about.</i> | News about Him spread to every place in the surrounding region. |
| 38 <i>And he arose out of the synagogue, and entered into Simon's house. And Simon's wife's mother was taken with a great fever; and they besought him for her.</i> | He left the synagogue and entered Simon's house. Simon's mother-in-law was suffering from a severe fever, and they asked Him to help her. |
| 39 <i>And he stood over her, and rebuked the fever; and it left her: and immediately she arose and ministered unto them.</i> | He stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. She immediately rose and began serving them. |
| 40 <i>Now when the sun was setting, all they that had any sick with divers diseases brought them unto him; and he laid his hands on every one of them, and healed them.</i> | When the sun was setting, all who had sick people with various diseases brought them to Him. He laid His hands on every one of them and healed them. |
| 41 <i>And devils also came out of many, crying out, and saying, Thou art Christ the Son of God. And he rebuking them suffered them not to speak: for they knew that he was Christ.</i> | Devils also came out of many, crying out and saying, "You are Christ the Son of God!" He rebuked them and would not allow them to speak, because they knew He was the Christ. |
| 42 <i>And when it was day, he departed and went into a desert place: and the people sought him, and came unto him, and stayed him, that he should not depart from them.</i> | When day came, He left and went to a deserted place. The people looked for him, came to him, and tried to keep Him from leaving them. |
| 43 <i>And he said unto them, I must preach the kingdom of God to other cities also: for therefore am I sent.</i> | But He said to them, "I must preach the kingdom of God to other cities also, for that is why I was sent." |
| 44 <i>And he preached in the synagogues of Galilee.</i> | He was preaching in the synagogues of Galilee. |

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Elisha (*eh-LY-shah*) — Elijah's successor who received a double portion of his spirit — performed many miracles including raising the dead; his name means 'God is salvation.'

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Nazareth (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

v1 — Matt 4:1-11; Acts 10:38; Mark 1:12-13; Luke 4:18; Isa 61:1

v2 — Ex 34:28; Heb 4:15; 1 Kgs 19:8; Heb 2:18; Deut 9:9

v4 — Deut 8:3; Matt 4:4; Matt 6:31; Eph 6:17; Ex 23:25

v6 — John 12:31; 1 John 5:19; John 14:30; Eph 2:2; Rev 13:7

v8 — Deut 6:13; Deut 10:20; Matt 4:10; Rev 19:10; Ps 83:18

v10 — Ps 91:11-12; Heb 1:14

v12 — Deut 6:16; Heb 3:8-9; Matt 4:7; 1 Cor 10:9

v18 — Isa 61:1; Matt 11:5; Ps 146:7-8; Acts 10:38; Luke 7:22

v21 — John 4:25-26; Acts 3:18; Matt 13:14; Luke 10:23-24; Acts 2:16-18

v22 — Matt 13:54-56; Ps 45:2; John 6:42; Acts 6:10; John 7:46

v24 — Matt 13:57; John 4:44; Mark 6:4-5

v40 — Mark 1:32-34; Matt 8:16-17; Mark 5:23

Chapter 5

Jesus teaches from Simon's boat, then commands a miraculous catch of fish so great the nets begin to break. He cleanses a leper, heals a paralytic lowered through the roof, and calls Levi the tax collector to follow Him.

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| <p>¹ <i>And it came to pass, that, as the people pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he stood by the lake of Gennesaret,</i></p> | <p>One day, as the crowd pressed around Him to hear the word of God, He was standing by the lake of Gennesaret.</p> |
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- 2 *And saw two ships standing by the lake: but the fishermen were gone out of them, and were washing their nets.* He saw two boats at the shore of the lake. The fishermen had left them and were washing their nets.
- 3 *And he entered into one of the ships, which was Simon's, and prayed him that he would thrust out a little from the land. And he sat down, and taught the people out of the ship.* He got into one of the boats, which was Simon's, and asked him to put out a little from the shore. Then He sat down and taught the people from the boat.
- 4 *Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon, Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught.* When he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, "Put out into the deep water and let down your nets for a catch."
- 5 *And Simon answering said unto him, Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net.* Simon answered, "Master, we have worked hard all night and caught nothing. But at Your word I will let down the net."
- 6 *And when they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake.* When they had done this, they caught a great number of fish, and their net began to break.
- 7 *And they beckoned unto their partners, which were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink.* They signaled to their partners in the other boat to come and help them. They came and filled both boats so full that they began to sink.
- 8 *When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord.* When Simon Peter saw this, he fell down at Jesus' knees and said, "Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, O Lord."
- 9 *For he was astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken:* He was astonished — and so were all who were with Him — at the catch of fish they had taken.

- 10 *And so was also James, and John, the sons of Zebedee, which were partners with Simon. And Jesus said unto Simon, Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men.* So also were James and John, the sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon. Jesus said to Simon, "Do not be afraid. From now on you will be catching men."
- 11 *And when they had brought their ships to land, they forsook all, and followed him.* When they had brought their boats to land, they left everything and followed Him.
- 12 *And it came to pass, when he was in a certain city, behold a man full of leprosy: who seeing Jesus fell on his face, and besought him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.* While He was in one of the cities, a man full of leprosy saw Jesus. He fell on His face and begged Him, "Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean."
- 13 *And he put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will: be thou clean. And immediately the leprosy departed from him.* Jesus stretched out His hand and touched Him, saying, "I am willing — be clean." Immediately the leprosy left Him.
- 14 *And he charged him to tell no man: but go, and shew thyself to the priest, and offer for thy cleansing, according as Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.* He told him to tell no one, but said, "Go and show yourself to the priest, and offer what Moses commanded for your cleansing, as a witness to them."
- 15 *But so much the more went there a fame abroad of him: and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities.* But the news about Him spread even more. Large crowds came together to hear Him and to be healed of their sicknesses.
- 16 *And he withdrew himself into the wilderness, and prayed.* But He would withdraw to deserted places and pray.

- 17 *And it came to pass on a certain day, as he was teaching, that there were Pharisees and doctors of the law sitting by, which were come out of every town of Galilee, and Judaea, and Jerusalem: and the power of the Lord was present to heal them.* One day as He was teaching, Pharisees and teachers of the law were sitting there. They had come from every village of Galilee and Judaea and from Jerusalem. The power of the Lord was present to heal.
- 18 *And, behold, men brought in a bed a man which was taken with a palsy: and they sought means to bring him in, and to lay him before him.* Some men brought on a bed a man who was paralyzed, and they tried to bring him in and lay Him before Jesus.
- 19 *And when they could not find by what way they might bring him in because of the multitude, they went upon the housetop, and let him down through the tiling with his couch into the midst before Jesus.* Finding no way to bring Him in because of the crowd, they went up on the roof and lowered Him on His mat through the tiles into the middle of the room, right before Jesus.
- 20 *And when he saw their faith, he said unto him, Man, thy sins are forgiven thee.* When He saw their faith, He said, "Man, Your sins are forgiven You."
- 21 *And the scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying, Who is this which speaketh blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone?* The scribes and Pharisees began to question this, saying, "Who is this who speaks blasphemy? Who can forgive sins but God alone?"
- 22 *But when Jesus perceived their thoughts, he answering said unto them, What reason ye in your hearts?* Jesus knew their thoughts and answered them, "Why are You reasoning in Your hearts?"
- 23 *Whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Rise up and walk?* Which is easier — to say, 'Your sins are forgiven You,' or to say, 'Rise and walk'?
- 24 *But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power upon earth to forgive sins, (he said unto the sick of the palsy,) I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy couch, and go into thine house.* But so that You may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins" — He said to the paralyzed man — "I say to You, rise, take up Your mat, and go home."

- 25 *And immediately he rose up before them, and took up that whereon he lay, and departed to his own house, glorifying God.* Immediately He rose before them all, took up what He had been lying on, and went home glorifying God.
- 26 *And they were all amazed, and they glorified God, and were filled with fear, saying, We have seen strange things to day.* They were all amazed and glorified God. They were filled with awe and said, "We have seen remarkable things today."
- 27 *And after these things he went forth, and saw a publican, named Levi, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he said unto him, Follow me.* After this He went out and saw a tax collector named Levi sitting at the tax booth. He said to Him, "Follow Me."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Levi** (LEE-vy) — "joined" or "attached" — Also called Matthew. A tax collector whom Jesus called to be His disciple. He left everything to follow Christ.

- 28 *And he left all, rose up, and followed him.* Levi left everything, rose up, and followed Him.
- 29 *And Levi made him a great feast in his own house: and there was a great company of publicans and of others that sat down with them.* Levi made a great banquet for Him at His house. A large crowd of tax collectors and others were reclining at the table with them.
- 30 *But their scribes and Pharisees murmured against his disciples, saying, Why do ye eat and drink with publicans and sinners?* The scribes and Pharisees complained to His disciples, saying, "Why do You eat and drink with tax collectors and sinners?"
- 31 *And Jesus answering said unto them, They that are whole need not a physician; but they that are sick.* Jesus answered them, "Those who are well have no need of a doctor, but those who are sick do.
- 32 *I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.* I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance."
- 33 *And they said unto him, Why do the disciples of John fast often, and make prayers, and likewise the disciples of the Pharisees; but thine eat and drink?* They said to Him, "John's disciples fast often and pray, and the disciples of the Pharisees do likewise. But Your disciples eat and drink."

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| 34 | <i>And he said unto them, Can ye make the children of the bridechamber fast, while the bridegroom is with them?</i> | He said to them, "Can You make the wedding guests fast while the bridegroom is with them?" |
| 35 | <i>But the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken away from them, and then shall they fast in those days.</i> | The days will come when the bridegroom is taken away from them — then they will fast in those days." |
| 36 | <i>And he spake also a parable unto them; No man putteth a piece of a new garment upon an old; if otherwise, then both the new maketh a rent, and the piece that was taken out of the new agreeth not with the old.</i> | He also told them a parable: "No one tears a piece from a new garment and sews it on an old one. If He does, the new piece will not match the old. |
| 37 | <i>And no man putteth new wine into old bottles; else the new wine will burst the bottles, and be spilled, and the bottles shall perish.</i> | No one puts new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the new wine will burst the skins, the wine will be spilled, and the skins will be ruined. |
| 38 | <i>But new wine must be put into new bottles; and both are preserved.</i> | New wine must be put into new wineskins, and both are preserved. |
| 39 | <i>No man also having drunk old wine straightway desireth new: for he saith, The old is better.</i> | No one who has drunk old wine wants the new right away, for He says, 'The old is better.'" |

Words in this chapter:

publican — A Jewish tax collector working for Rome — despised by fellow Jews as a traitor and swindler; also called 'tax collectors' in modern translations.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Mark 1:16-20; Matt 4:18-22; Mark 3:9; Matt 14:34

- v4 — John 21:6; Matt 17:27
v5 — John 2:5; John 15:14; Luke 6:46-48; 2 Kgs 5:10-14; Ezek 37:4-7
v8 — Isa 6:5; Job 42:5-6; Rev 1:17; Judg 13:22; Job 40:4
v10 — Matt 13:47; Matt 4:19; Ezek 47:9-10; Mark 1:17
v11 — Matt 4:20; Luke 5:28; Matt 19:27; Luke 18:28-30
v12 — Ps 50:15; Matt 8:2-4; Luke 17:16; Luke 17:12-13; Matt 9:28
v16 — Mark 1:35-36; Luke 6:12; Matt 14:23; Mark 6:46; John 6:15
v17 — Luke 6:19; Luke 8:46; Matt 11:5; Acts 19:11; Matt 15:1
v31 — Mark 2:17; Matt 9:12-13
v32 — Luke 19:10; Luke 15:10; 1 Tim 1:15-16; Luke 15:7; Acts 3:19
v38 — Heb 8:8-13; 2 Cor 5:17; Ezek 36:26; Gal 5:1-6; Rev 21:5

Chapter 6

Jesus defends His disciples for plucking grain on the Sabbath and heals a man with a withered hand, provoking the scribes and Pharisees. He chooses the twelve apostles and delivers the Sermon on the Plain, teaching about blessings and woes, loving one's enemies, judging others, and building on a sure foundation.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass on the second sabbath after the first, that he went through the corn fields; and his disciples plucked the ears of corn, and did eat, rubbing them in their hands.</i></p> | <p>On a Sabbath, as He was passing through the grain fields, His disciples plucked heads of grain, rubbed them in their hands, and ate them.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And certain of the Pharisees said unto them, Why do ye that which is not lawful to do on the sabbath days?</i></p> | <p>Some of the Pharisees said, "Why are You doing what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath?"</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Jesus answering them said, Have ye not read so much as this, what David did, when himself was an hungred, and they which were with him;</i></p> | <p>Jesus answered them, "Have You not read what David did when he was hungry, and those who were with Him —</p> |
| <p>4 <i>How he went into the house of God, and did take and eat the shewbread, and gave also to them that were with him; which it is not lawful to eat but for the priests alone?</i></p> | <p>how He entered the house of God and took and ate the showbread, and gave some to those with Him? This bread is not lawful for anyone to eat except the priests alone."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And he said unto them, That the Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "The Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath."</p> |

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| <p>6 <i>And it came to pass also on another sabbath, that he entered into the synagogue and taught: and there was a man whose right hand was withered.</i></p> | <p>On another Sabbath He entered the synagogue and taught. A man was there whose right hand was withered.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And the scribes and Pharisees watched him, whether he would heal on the sabbath day; that they might find an accusation against him.</i></p> | <p>The scribes and Pharisees were watching Him closely to see whether He would heal on the Sabbath, so they could find a reason to accuse Him.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>But he knew their thoughts, and said to the man which had the withered hand, Rise up, and stand forth in the midst. And he arose and stood forth.</i></p> | <p>But He knew their thoughts and said to the man with the withered hand, "Rise and stand in the middle." He rose and stood there.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Then said Jesus unto them, I will ask you one thing; Is it lawful on the sabbath days to do good, or to do evil? to save life, or to destroy it?</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to them, "I ask You one thing: Is it lawful on the Sabbath to do good or to do evil? To save life or to destroy it?"</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And looking round about upon them all, he said unto the man, Stretch forth thy hand. And he did so: and his hand was restored whole as the other.</i></p> | <p>He looked around at all of them and said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He did so, and his hand was restored.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>And they were filled with madness; and communed one with another what they might do to Jesus.</i></p> | <p>They were filled with fury and discussed with one another what they might do to Jesus.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And it came to pass in those days, that he went out into a mountain to pray, and continued all night in prayer to God.</i></p> | <p>In those days He went out to the mountain to pray and spent the whole night in prayer to God.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And when it was day, he called unto him his disciples: and of them he chose twelve, whom also he named apostles;</i></p> | <p>When day came, He called His disciples and chose twelve of them, whom He named apostles:</p> |

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| 14 <i>Simon, (whom he also named Peter,) and Andrew his brother, James and John, Philip and Bartholomew,</i> | Simon (whom he named Peter), Andrew his brother, James and John, Philip and Bartholomew, |
| 15 <i>Matthew and Thomas, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon called Zelotes,</i> | Matthew and Thomas, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon called Zelotes, |
| 16 <i>And Judas the brother of James, and Judas Iscariot, which also was the traitor.</i> | Judas the brother of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor. |
| 17 <i>And he came down with them, and stood in the plain, and the company of his disciples, and a great multitude of people out of all Judaea and Jerusalem, and from the sea coast of Tyre and Sidon, which came to hear him, and to be healed of their diseases;</i> | He came down with them and stood on a level place. A large crowd of His disciples was there, along with a great number of people from all Judaea and Jerusalem and from the coastal region of Tyre and Sidon. They came to hear Him and to be healed of their diseases. |
| 18 <i>And they that were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed.</i> | Those troubled by unclean spirits were also healed. |
| 19 <i>And the whole multitude sought to touch him: for there went virtue out of him, and healed them all.</i> | The whole crowd was trying to touch Him, because power was going out from Him and healing everyone. |
| 20 <i>And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said, Blessed be ye poor: for yours is the kingdom of God.</i> | He lifted up His eyes on His disciples and said: "Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God. |
| 21 <i>Blessed are ye that hunger now: for ye shall be filled. Blessed are ye that weep now: for ye shall laugh.</i> | Blessed are you who hunger now, for you will be filled. Blessed are you who weep now, for you will laugh. |
| 22 <i>Blessed are ye, when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you from their company, and shall reproach you, and cast out your name as evil, for the Son of man's sake.</i> | Blessed are You when people hate You, exclude You, insult You, and reject Your name as evil because of the Son of Man. |

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| <p>23 <i>Rejoice ye in that day, and leap for joy: for, behold, your reward is great in heaven: for in the like manner did their fathers unto the prophets.</i></p> | <p>Rejoice in that day and leap for joy, for Your reward is great in heaven. Their fathers treated the prophets the same way.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>But woe unto you that are rich! for ye have received your consolation.</i></p> | <p>But woe to You who are rich, for You have already received Your comfort.</p> |
| <p>25 <i>Woe unto you that are full! for ye shall hunger. Woe unto you that laugh now! for ye shall mourn and weep.</i></p> | <p>Woe to You who are full now, for You will hunger. Woe to You who laugh now, for You will mourn and weep.</p> |
| <p>26 <i>Woe unto you, when all men shall speak well of you! for so did their fathers to the false prophets.</i></p> | <p>Woe to You when everyone speaks well of You, for that is what their fathers did to the false prophets.</p> |
| <p>27 <i>But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you,</i></p> | <p>But I say to You who hear: Love Your enemies. Do good to those who hate You.</p> |
| <p>28 <i>Bless them that curse you, and pray for them which despitefully use you.</i></p> | <p>Bless those who curse You. Pray for those who mistreat You.</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloke forbid not to take thy coat also.</i></p> | <p>To the one who strikes you on the cheek, offer the other also. To the one who takes your coat, do not withhold your shirt either.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>Give to every man that asketh of thee; and of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again.</i></p> | <p>Give to everyone who asks of You. From the one who takes your things, do not demand them back.</p> |
| <p>31 <i>And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.</i></p> | <p>Do to others as You would have them do to You.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>For if ye love them which love you, what thank have ye? for sinners also love those that love them.</i></p> | <p>If You love those who love You, what credit is that to You? Even sinners love those who love them.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And if ye do good to them which do good to you, what thank have ye? for sinners also do even the same.</i></p> | <p>If You do good to those who do good to You, what credit is that to You? Even sinners do the same.</p> |

- 34 *And if ye lend to them of whom ye hope to receive, what thank have ye? for sinners also lend to sinners, to receive as much again.* If You lend to those from whom You expect repayment, what credit is that to You? Even sinners lend to sinners to get back the same amount.
- 35 *But love ye your enemies, and do good, and lend, hoping for nothing again; and your reward shall be great, and ye shall be the children of the Highest: for he is kind unto the unthankful and to the evil.* But love Your enemies, do good, and lend without expecting anything back. Your reward will be great, and You will be children of the Highest, for He is kind to the ungrateful and the evil.
- 36 *Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful.* Be merciful, just as Your Father is merciful.
- 37 *Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive, and ye shall be forgiven:* Do not judge, and You will not be judged. Do not condemn, and You will not be condemned. Forgive, and You will be forgiven.
- 38 *Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.* Give, and it will be given to You — good measure, pressed down, shaken together, and running over, will be poured into Your lap. For with the measure You use, it will be measured back to You."
- 39 *And he spake a parable unto them, Can the blind lead the blind? shall they not both fall into the ditch?* He also told them a parable: "Can the blind lead the blind? Will they not both fall into a ditch?
- 40 *The disciple is not above his master: but every one that is perfect shall be as his master.* A disciple is not above His teacher, but everyone who is fully trained will be like His teacher.
- 41 *And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but perceivest not the beam that is in thine own eye?* Why do You see the speck in Your brother's eye but fail to notice the beam in Your own eye?

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| <p>42 <i>Either how canst thou say to thy brother, Brother, let me pull out the mote that is in thine eye, when thou thyself beholdest not the beam that is in thine own eye? Thou hypocrite, cast out first the beam out of thine own eye, and then shalt thou see clearly to pull out the mote that is in thy brother's eye.</i></p> | <p>How can You say to Your brother, 'Brother, let me remove the speck from Your eye,' when You don't see the beam in Your own eye? You hypocrite — first take the beam out of Your own eye, and then You will see clearly to remove the speck from Your brother's eye.</p> |
| <p>43 <i>For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.</i></p> | <p>A good tree does not produce corrupt fruit, and a corrupt tree does not produce good fruit.</p> |
| <p>44 <i>For every tree is known by his own fruit. For of thorns men do not gather figs, nor of a bramble bush gather they grapes.</i></p> | <p>Every tree is known by its own fruit. People do not gather figs from thorns, or grapes from a bramble bush.</p> |
| <p>45 <i>A good man out of the good treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is good; and an evil man out of the evil treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is evil: for of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaketh.</i></p> | <p>A good man brings forth good from the good stored in His heart. An evil man brings forth evil from the evil stored in His heart. For out of the overflow of the heart the mouth speaks.</p> |
| <p>46 <i>And why call ye me, Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?</i></p> | <p>Why do You call Me 'Lord, Lord,' and not do what I say?</p> |
| <p>47 <i>Whosoever cometh to me, and heareth my sayings, and doeth them, I will shew you to whom he is like:</i></p> | <p>Everyone who comes to Me and hears My words and does them — I will show You what He is like.</p> |
| <p>48 <i>He is like a man which built an house, and digged deep, and laid the foundation on a rock: and when the flood arose, the stream beat vehemently upon that house, and could not shake it: for it was founded upon a rock.</i></p> | <p>He is like a man who built a house and dug deep, laying the foundation on rock. When the flood rose, the stream beat against that house but could not shake it, because it was built on rock.</p> |

49 *But he that heareth, and doeth not, is like a man that without a foundation built an house upon the earth; against which the stream did beat vehemently, and immediately it fell; and the ruin of that house was great.* But the one who hears and does not act is like a man who built a house on the ground without a foundation. When the stream beat against it, it immediately collapsed, and the ruin was great."

Words in this chapter:

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Cross-References:

- v22 — Matt 5:10-12; Matt 10:22; 1 Pet 4:12-16; 1 Pet 3:14; 1 Thess 2:14-15
- v26 — John 15:19; Jas 4:4; Matt 7:15; Mic 2:11; 1 John 4:5-6
- v27 — 1 Thess 5:15; Luke 6:35; Rom 12:17-21; Prov 25:21-22; Prov 24:17
- v28 — 1 Pet 3:9; 1 Cor 4:12; Rom 12:14; Jas 3:10; Luke 23:34
- v31 — Matt 7:12; Gal 5:14; Matt 22:39; Jas 2:8-16
- v35 — Matt 5:44-45; John 13:35; Prov 19:17; Rom 5:8-10; Ps 145:9
- v37 — Eph 4:32; Jas 5:9; Matt 7:1-5; Mark 11:25; 1 Cor 13:4-7
- v38 — 2 Cor 9:6-8; Deut 15:10; Mark 4:24; Prov 3:9-10; Matt 7:2
- v45 — Prov 4:23; Matt 12:34-37; Eph 4:29; John 7:38; Ps 37:30-31
- v46 — Matt 7:21-23; Gal 6:7; Mal 1:6; Luke 13:25-27; Matt 25:44
- v47 — Jas 1:22-25; Matt 7:24-27; Luke 11:28; John 14:15; Jas 4:17
- v48 — 1 Cor 3:10-15; Matt 7:25-26; Ps 62:2; Isa 28:16; Jude 1:24

Chapter 7

Jesus heals the centurion's servant from a distance, marveling at the centurion's faith, and raises a widow's dead son at Nain. John the Baptist sends messengers asking if Jesus is the one who was to come, and Jesus answers by pointing to His miracles. A sinful woman washes Jesus's feet with her tears and anoints them with ointment, and Jesus forgives her sins.

- 1 *Now when he had ended all his sayings in the audience of the people, he entered into Capernaum.* When He had finished all His sayings in the hearing of the people, he entered Capernaum.
- 2 *And a certain centurion's servant, who was dear unto him, was sick, and ready to die.* A certain centurion had a servant who was dear to Him, and the servant was sick and near death.

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| <p>3 <i>And when he heard of Jesus, he sent unto him the elders of the Jews, beseeching him that he would come and heal his servant.</i></p> | <p>When the centurion heard about Jesus, He sent some elders of the Jews to Him, asking Him to come and heal His servant.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And when they came to Jesus, they besought him instantly, saying, That he was worthy for whom he should do this:</i></p> | <p>When they came to Jesus, they pleaded earnestly with Him, saying, "He is worthy for You to do this,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For he loveth our nation, and he hath built us a synagogue.</i></p> | <p>for He loves our nation and built us a synagogue."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Then Jesus went with them. And when he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying unto him, Lord, trouble not thyself: for I am not worthy that thou shouldest enter under my roof:</i></p> | <p>Jesus went with them. When He was not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to say, "Lord, do not trouble Yourself, for I am not worthy that You should come under my roof.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Wherefore neither thought I myself worthy to come unto thee: but say in a word, and my servant shall be healed.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I did not think myself worthy to come to You. But say the word, and my servant will be healed.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>For I also am a man set under authority, having under me soldiers, and I say unto one, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.</i></p> | <p>For I myself am a man placed under authority, with soldiers under me. I say to one, 'Go,' and He goes; to another, 'Come,' and He comes; to my servant, 'Do this,' and He does it."</p> |
| <p>9 <i>When Jesus heard these things, he marvelled at him, and turned him about, and said unto the people that followed him, I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.</i></p> | <p>When Jesus heard this, he marveled at the centurion and turned to the crowd following him. He said, "I tell you, not even in Israel have I found such great faith."</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And they that were sent, returning to the house, found the servant whole that had been sick.</i></p> | <p>When those who had been sent returned to the house, they found the servant well.</p> |

- 11 *And it came to pass the day after, that he went into a city called Nain; and many of his disciples went with him, and much people.* Soon afterward He went to a city called Nain. His disciples and a large crowd went with Him.
- 12 *Now when he came nigh to the gate of the city, behold, there was a dead man carried out, the only son of his mother, and she was a widow: and much people of the city was with her.* As He drew near to the gate of the city, a man who had died was being carried out — the only son of His mother, and she was a widow. A large crowd from the city was with her.
- 13 *And when the Lord saw her, he had compassion on her, and said unto her, Weep not.* When the Lord saw her, He had compassion on her and said, "Do not weep."
- 14 *And he came and touched the bier: and they that bare him stood still. And he said, Young man, I say unto thee, Arise.* He came and touched the coffin, and those carrying it stopped. He said, "Young man, I say to You, arise."
- 15 *And he that was dead sat up, and began to speak. And he delivered him to his mother.* The dead man sat up and began to speak, and Jesus gave Him back to His mother.
- 16 *And there came a fear on all: and they glorified God, saying, That a great prophet is risen up among us; and, That God hath visited his people.* Fear came on everyone, and they glorified God, saying, "A great prophet has risen among us!" and "God has visited His people!"
- 17 *And this rumour of him went forth throughout all Judaea, and throughout all the region round about.* This report about Him spread through all Judaea and the surrounding region.
- 18 *And the disciples of John shewed him of all these things.* The disciples of John told him about all these things.
- 19 *And John calling unto him two of his disciples sent them to Jesus, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?* John called two of his disciples and sent them to the Lord, saying, "Are You the One who is to come, or should we look for another?"

- 20 *When the men were come unto him, they said, John Baptist hath sent us unto thee, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?* When the men came to Him, they said, "John the Baptist has sent us to you, saying, 'Are you the One who is to come, or should we look for another?'"
- 21 *And in that same hour he cured many of their infirmities and plagues, and of evil spirits; and unto many that were blind he gave sight.* In that same hour He healed many people of sicknesses and afflictions and evil spirits, and gave sight to many who were blind.
- 22 *Then Jesus answering said unto them, Go your way, and tell John what things ye have seen and heard; how that the blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, to the poor the gospel is preached.* He answered them, "Go and tell John what you have seen and heard: the blind receive sight, the lame walk, lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, the poor have the gospel preached to them.
- 23 *And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.* Blessed is the one who is not offended by Me."
- 24 *And when the messengers of John were departed, he began to speak unto the people concerning John, What went ye out into the wilderness for to see? A reed shaken with the wind?* When John's messengers had gone, Jesus began to speak to the crowd about John: "What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind?
- 25 *But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? Behold, they which are gorgeously apparelled, and live delicately, are in kings' courts.* What did You go out to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? Those who wear fine clothes and live in luxury are in royal palaces.
- 26 *But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? Yea, I say unto you, and much more than a prophet.* What did You go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell You, and much more than a prophet.
- 27 *This is he, of whom it is written, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.* This is the one about whom it is written: 'I send My messenger before Your face, who will prepare Your way before You.'

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| <p>28 <i>For I say unto you, Among those that are born of women there is not a greater prophet than John the Baptist: but he that is least in the kingdom of God is greater than he.</i></p> | <p>I tell You, among those born of women there is no greater prophet than John the Baptist. Yet the one who is least in the kingdom of God is greater than He."</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And all the people that heard him, and the publicans, justified God, being baptized with the baptism of John.</i></p> | <p>All the people who heard him, even the tax collectors, acknowledged God's justice, having been baptized with John's baptism.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>But the Pharisees and lawyers rejected the counsel of God against themselves, being not baptized of him.</i></p> | <p>But the Pharisees and experts in the law rejected God's purpose for themselves, not having been baptized by John.</p> |
| <p>31 <i>And the Lord said, Whereunto then shall I liken the men of this generation? and to what are they like?</i></p> | <p>The Lord said, "To what then shall I compare the people of this generation? What are they like?</p> |
| <p>32 <i>They are like unto children sitting in the marketplace, and calling one to another, and saying, We have piped unto you, and ye have not danced; we have mourned to you, and ye have not wept.</i></p> | <p>They are like children sitting in the marketplace, calling to one another: 'We played the flute for You, and You did not dance; we sang a lament, and You did not weep.'</p> |
| <p>33 <i>For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine; and ye say, He hath a devil.</i></p> | <p>For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine, and You say, 'He has a devil.'</p> |
| <p>34 <i>The Son of man is come eating and drinking; and ye say, Behold a gluttonous man, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners!</i></p> | <p>The Son of Man has come eating and drinking, and You say, 'Look, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!'</p> |
| <p>35 <i>But wisdom is justified of all her children.</i></p> | <p>Yet wisdom is vindicated by all her children."</p> |

- 36 *And one of the Pharisees desired him that he would eat with him. And he went into the Pharisee's house, and sat down to meat.* One of the Pharisees asked Him to eat with Him. He entered the Pharisee's house and reclined at the table.
- 37 *And, behold, a woman in the city, which was a sinner, when she knew that Jesus sat at meat in the Pharisee's house, brought an alabaster box of ointment,* A woman of the city who was a sinner learned that he was reclining at the Pharisee's house. She brought an alabaster flask of ointment,
- 38 *And stood at his feet behind him weeping, and began to wash his feet with tears, and did wipe them with the hairs of her head, and kissed his feet, and anointed them with the ointment.* and standing behind Him at His feet, weeping, she began to wet His feet with her tears. She wiped them with her hair, kissed His feet, and anointed them with the ointment.
- 39 *Now when the Pharisee which had bidden him saw it, he spake within himself, saying, This man, if he were a prophet, would have known who and what manner of woman this is that toucheth him: for she is a sinner.* When the Pharisee who had invited him saw this, he said to himself, "If this man were a prophet, he would know who and what kind of woman is touching Him — she is a sinner."
- 40 *And Jesus answering said unto him, Simon, I have somewhat to say unto thee. And he saith, Master, say on.* Jesus answered Him, "Simon, I have something to say to you." He said, "Master, say it."
- 41 *There was a certain creditor which had two debtors: the one owed five hundred pence, and the other fifty.* "A certain creditor had two debtors. One owed five hundred denarii and the other fifty.
- 42 *And when they had nothing to pay, he frankly forgave them both. Tell me therefore, which of them will love him most?* When neither of them could pay, He cancelled both debts. Which of them will love Him more?"
- 43 *Simon answered and said, I suppose that he, to whom he forgave most. And he said unto him, Thou hast rightly judged.* Simon answered, "The one who had the larger debt cancelled, I suppose." He said to Him, "You have judged correctly."

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| <p>44 <i>And he turned to the woman, and said unto Simon, Seest thou this woman? I entered into thine house, thou gavest me no water for my feet: but she hath washed my feet with tears, and wiped them with the hairs of her head.</i></p> <p>45 <i>Thou gavest me no kiss: but this woman since the time I came in hath not ceased to kiss my feet.</i></p> <p>46 <i>My head with oil thou didst not anoint: but this woman hath anointed my feet with ointment.</i></p> <p>47 <i>Wherefore I say unto thee, Her sins, which are many, are forgiven; for she loved much: but to whom little is forgiven, the same loveth little.</i></p> <p>48 <i>And he said unto her, Thy sins are forgiven.</i></p> <p>49 <i>And they that sat at meat with him began to say within themselves, Who is this that forgiveth sins also?</i></p> <p>50 <i>And he said to the woman, Thy faith hath saved thee; go in peace.</i></p> | <p>Turning to the woman he said to Simon, "Do you see this woman? I entered your house. You gave Me no water for My feet, but she washed My feet with her tears and wiped them with her hair.</p> <p>You gave Me no kiss, but she has not stopped kissing My feet since I came in.</p> <p>You did not anoint My head with oil, but she has anointed My feet with ointment.</p> <p>Therefore I tell you, her many sins are forgiven — she loved much. But the one who is forgiven little loves little."</p> <p>He said to her, "Your sins are forgiven."</p> <p>Those reclining at the table began to say among themselves, "Who is this who even forgives sins?"</p> <p>He said to the woman, "Your faith has saved you. Go in peace."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

centurion (*sen-TYUR-ee-un*) — A Roman army officer commanding approximately 100 soldiers — several centurions in the NT show unusual faith in Jesus.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

v7 — Ps 107:20; Ps 33:9; Luke 4:36; Mark 1:27

v13 — Ps 103:13; Isa 63:9; Lam 3:32-33; Heb 4:15; Ps 86:15

v14 — John 11:43-44; John 5:25; Acts 9:40-41; John 11:25

v22 — Isa 35:5-6; Isa 61:1-3; Luke 4:18; Isa 29:18-19; Jas 2:5

v23 — 1 Pet 2:7-8; Rom 9:32-33; Matt 11:6; Isa 8:14-15; Matt 13:57-58

v27 — Mal 3:1; Luke 1:76

v28 — Matt 13:16-17; Heb 11:39-40; Matt 11:11; Col 1:25-27; Luke 9:48

v35 — Prov 8:32-36; Matt 11:19; 1 Cor 2:14-15; Hos 14:9; Prov 17:16

v36 — Mark 14:3-9; Matt 26:5-6; Luke 14:1; John 11:2-16

v37 — Mark 14:3-9; Matt 26:6-13; Luke 7:37-39; Luke 5:30; Matt 21:31

v47 — 1 John 4:19; 1 John 3:18; Rom 5:20; Gal 5:6; Isa 1:18

v50 — Mark 5:34; Luke 8:48; Luke 18:42; Matt 9:22; Mark 10:52

Chapter 8

Jesus travels through cities and villages preaching, accompanied by the twelve and several women who provide for Him. He tells the parable of the sower, calms a storm on the sea, casts a legion of demons out of a man among the tombs, heals a woman with a twelve-year flow of blood, and raises Jairus's daughter from the dead.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass afterward, that he went throughout every city and village, preaching and shewing the glad tidings of the kingdom of God: and the twelve were with him,</i></p> | <p>After this He traveled through every city and village, preaching and proclaiming the good news of the kingdom of God. The twelve were with Him,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And certain women, which had been healed of evil spirits and infirmities, Mary called Magdalene, out of whom went seven devils,</i></p> | <p>and also some women who had been healed of evil spirits and sicknesses: Mary called Magdalene, out of whom seven devils had gone,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And Joanna the wife of Chuza Herod's steward, and Susanna, and many others, which ministered unto him of their substance.</i></p> | <p>Joanna the wife of Chuza, Herod's steward, and Susanna, and many others. These women served Him out of their own means.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And when much people were gathered together, and were come to him out of every city, he spake by a parable:</i></p> | <p>When a large crowd was gathering and people were coming to Him from every city, He spoke by a parable:</p> |
| <p>5 <i>A sower went out to sow his seed: and as he sowed, some fell by the way side; and it was trodden down, and the fowls of the air devoured it.</i></p> | <p>"A sower went out to sow his seed. As he sowed, some fell along the path, was trampled, and the birds of the air devoured it.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And some fell upon a rock; and as soon as it was sprung up, it withered away, because it lacked moisture.</i></p> | <p>Some fell on the rock, and as it grew up it withered away because it had no moisture.</p> |

- 7 *And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprang up with it, and choked it.* Some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up with it and choked it.
- 8 *And other fell on good ground, and sprang up, and bare fruit an hundredfold. And when he had said these things, he cried, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.* Other seed fell on good ground and grew up and produced a hundredfold." As He said this, He called out, "Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear."
- 9 *And his disciples asked him, saying, What might this parable be?* His disciples asked Him what this parable meant.
- 10 *And he said, Unto you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God: but to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand.* He said, "To you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God, but to others I speak in parables, so that seeing they may not see, and hearing they may not understand.
- 11 *Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God.* Now this is what the parable means: The seed is the word of God.
- 12 *Those by the way side are they that hear; then cometh the devil, and taketh away the word out of their hearts, lest they should believe and be saved.* Those along the path are those who hear, but then the devil comes and takes away the word from their hearts, so that they may not believe and be saved.
- 13 *They on the rock are they, which, when they hear, receive the word with joy; and these have no root, which for a while believe, and in time of temptation fall away.* Those on the rock are those who receive the word with joy when they hear it, but they have no root. They believe for a while, and in a time of testing they fall away.
- 14 *And that which fell among thorns are they, which, when they have heard, go forth, and are choked with cares and riches and pleasures of this life, and bring no fruit to perfection.* The seed that fell among thorns — these are those who hear, but as they go on their way they are choked by life's worries, riches, and pleasures, and they never mature.

- 15 *But that on the good ground are they, which in an honest and good heart, having heard the word, keep it, and bring forth fruit with patience.* The seed on the good ground — these are those who hear the word with an honest and good heart, hold it fast, and produce fruit with patience.
- 16 *No man, when he hath lighted a candle, covereth it with a vessel, or putteth it under a bed; but setteth it on a candlestick, that they which enter in may see the light.* No one lights a lamp and covers it with a jar or puts it under a bed. He puts it on a stand so that those who enter may see the light.
- 17 *For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad.* For nothing is secret that will not be revealed, and nothing is hidden that will not be known and come to light.
- 18 *Take heed therefore how ye hear: for whosoever hath, to him shall be given; and whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he seemeth to have.* Therefore take care how you hear. Whoever has, more will be given to him. Whoever does not have, even what he thinks he has will be taken from him."
- 19 *Then came to him his mother and his brethren, and could not come at him for the press.* His mother and brothers came to Him, but they could not reach Him because of the crowd.
- 20 *And it was told him by certain which said, Thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to see thee.* Someone told him, "Your mother and your brothers are standing outside, wanting to see You."
- 21 *And he answered and said unto them, My mother and my brethren are these which hear the word of God, and do it.* He answered them, "My mother and My brothers are those who hear the word of God and do it."
- 22 *Now it came to pass on a certain day, that he went into a ship with his disciples: and he said unto them, Let us go over unto the other side of the lake. And they launched forth.* One day He got into a boat with His disciples and said, "Let us go over to the other side of the lake." They set out.

- 23 *But as they sailed he fell asleep: and there came down a storm of wind on the lake; and they were filled with water, and were in jeopardy.* As they were sailing He fell asleep. A windstorm came down on the lake, the boat was filling with water, and they were in danger.
- 24 *And they came to him, and awoke him, saying, Master, master, we perish. Then he arose, and rebuked the wind and the raging of the water: and they ceased, and there was a calm.* They came to Him and woke Him, saying, "Master, Master, we are perishing!" He rose and rebuked the wind and the raging waves. They stopped, and there was calm.
- 25 *And he said unto them, Where is your faith? And they being afraid wondered, saying one to another, What manner of man is this! for he commandeth even the winds and water, and they obey him.* He said to them, "Where is your faith?" Afraid and amazed, they said to one another, "Who is this? He commands even the winds and the water, and they obey Him!"
- 26 *And they arrived at the country of the Gadarenes, which is over against Galilee.* They sailed to the region of the Gadarenes, which is across from Galilee.
- 27 *And when he went forth to land, there met him out of the city a certain man, which had devils long time, and ware no clothes, neither abode in any house, but in the tombs.* When He stepped ashore, a man from the city met him who had had devils for a long time. He wore no clothes and did not live in a house but among the tombs.
- 28 *When he saw Jesus, he cried out, and fell down before him, and with a loud voice said, What have I to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God most high? I beseech thee, torment me not.* When He saw Jesus, He cried out, fell down before Him, and said with a loud voice, "What do You want with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I beg You, do not torment me!"
- 29 *(For he had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. For oftentimes it had caught him: and he was kept bound with chains and in fetters; and he brake the bands, and was driven of the devil into the wilderness.)* For Jesus had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. Many times it had seized him, and though he was bound with chains and shackles, He would break them and be driven by the devil into the wilderness.

- 30 *And Jesus asked him, saying, What is thy name? And he said, Legion: because many devils were entered into him.* Jesus asked Him, "What is Your name?" He said, "Legion," because many devils had entered Him.
- 31 *And they besought him that he would not command them to go out into the deep.* They begged Him not to command them to go into the abyss.
- 32 *And there was there an herd of many swine feeding on the mountain: and they besought him that he would suffer them to enter into them. And he suffered them.* A large herd of pigs was feeding on the hillside. The devils begged Him to let them enter the pigs, and He allowed it.
- 33 *Then went the devils out of the man, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the lake, and were choked.* The devils came out of the man and entered the pigs. The herd rushed down the steep bank into the lake and drowned.
- 34 *When they that fed them saw what was done, they fled, and went and told it in the city and in the country.* When the herdsmen saw what had happened, they fled and reported it in the city and in the countryside.
- 35 *Then they went out to see what was done; and came to Jesus, and found the man, out of whom the devils were departed, sitting at the feet of Jesus, clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid.* People went out to see what had happened. They came to Jesus and found the man from whom the devils had gone, sitting at Jesus' feet, clothed and in His right mind. They were afraid.
- 36 *They also which saw it told them by what means he that was possessed of the devils was healed.* Those who had seen it told them how the demon-possessed man had been healed.
- 37 *Then the whole multitude of the country of the Gadarenes round about besought him to depart from them; for they were taken with great fear: and he went up into the ship, and returned back again.* The whole crowd from the region of the Gadarenes asked Him to leave them, for they were seized with great fear. So He got into the boat and returned.

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| <p>38 <i>Now the man out of whom the devils were departed besought him that he might be with him: but Jesus sent him away, saying,</i></p> | <p>The man from whom the devils had gone begged to be with Him. But Jesus sent Him away, saying,</p> |
| <p>39 <i>Return to thine own house, and shew how great things God hath done unto thee. And he went his way, and published throughout the whole city how great things Jesus had done unto him.</i></p> | <p>"Return to Your home and tell how much God has done for You." He went away and proclaimed throughout the whole city how much Jesus had done for Him.</p> |
| <p>40 <i>And it came to pass, that, when Jesus was returned, the people gladly received him: for they were all waiting for him.</i></p> | <p>When Jesus returned, the crowd welcomed Him, for they were all waiting for Him.</p> |
| <p>41 <i>And, behold, there came a man named Jairus, and he was a ruler of the synagogue: and he fell down at Jesus' feet, and besought him that he would come into his house:</i></p> | <p>A man named Jairus, who was a ruler of the synagogue, came and fell at Jesus' feet. He begged Him to come to His house,</p> |
- **NAME NOTE** — **Jairus** (JAY-ih-rus) — "he will enlighten" or "God enlightens" — A ruler of the synagogue whose daughter Jesus raised from the dead.
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| <p>42 <i>For he had one only daughter, about twelve years of age, and she lay a dying. But as he went the people thronged him.</i></p> | <p>for He had an only daughter about twelve years old, and she was dying. As Jesus went, the crowd pressed around Him.</p> |
| <p>43 <i>And a woman having an issue of blood twelve years, which had spent all her living upon physicians, neither could be healed of any,</i></p> | <p>A woman who had a discharge of blood for twelve years — who had spent all she had on doctors and could not be healed by any of them —</p> |
| <p>44 <i>Came behind him, and touched the border of his garment: and immediately her issue of blood stanchd.</i></p> | <p>came up behind Him and touched the edge of His garment. Immediately her discharge of blood stopped.</p> |

- 45 *And Jesus said, Who touched me? When all denied, Peter and they that were with him said, Master, the multitude throng thee and press thee, and sayest thou, Who touched me?* Jesus said, "Who touched Me?" When all denied it, Peter said, "Master, the crowd surrounds you and presses in on You — how can You ask, 'Who touched Me?'"
- 46 *And Jesus said, Somebody hath touched me: for I perceive that virtue is gone out of me.* Jesus said, "Someone has touched Me, for I know that power has gone out from Me."
- 47 *And when the woman saw that she was not hid, she came trembling, and falling down before him, she declared unto him before all the people for what cause she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.* When the woman saw that she was discovered, she came trembling. Falling down before Him, she declared in front of all the people why she had touched him and how she had been healed immediately.
- 48 *And he said unto her, Daughter, be of good comfort: thy faith hath made thee whole; go in peace.* He said to her, "Daughter, be of good comfort — your faith has made you whole. Go in peace."
- 49 *While he yet spake, there cometh one from the ruler of the synagogue's house, saying to him, Thy daughter is dead; trouble not the Master.* While He was still speaking, someone came from the ruler of the synagogue's house and said, "Your daughter is dead. Trouble not the Master."
- 50 *But when Jesus heard it, he answered him, saying, Fear not: believe only, and she shall be made whole.* Hearing this, Jesus answered Him, "Do not be afraid — only believe, and she will be made well."
- 51 *And when he came into the house, he suffered no man to go in, save Peter, and James, and John, and the father and the mother of the maiden.* When He came to the house, He allowed no one to enter with him except Peter, James, John, and the child's father and mother.
- 52 *And all wept, and bewailed her: but he said, Weep not; she is not dead, but sleepeth.* All were weeping and mourning for her. He said, "Do not weep. She is not dead, but sleeping."
- 53 *And they laughed him to scorn, knowing that she was dead.* They laughed at Him, knowing she was dead.

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| 54 | <i>And he put them all out, and took her by the hand, and called, saying, Maid, arise.</i> | He took her by the hand and called out, "Child, arise!" |
| 55 | <i>And her spirit came again, and she arose straightway: and he commanded to give her meat.</i> | Her spirit returned, and she got up immediately. He directed that something be given to her to eat. |
| 56 | <i>And her parents were astonished: but he charged them that they should tell no man what was done.</i> | Her parents were astonished, but He directed them to tell no one what had happened. |
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Words in this chapter:

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Cross-References:

- v10** — Isa 6:9; Mark 4:11; Matt 11:25; Jer 5:21; Isa 44:18
- v11** — 1 Pet 1:23-25; Mark 4:14-20; Matt 13:19; Jas 1:21; 1 Cor 3:9-12
- v12** — 2 Thess 2:9-14; Rev 12:9; Matt 13:19; Mark 4:15; Prov 1:24-26
- v14** — 1 John 2:15-17; 1 Tim 6:9-10; 1 Tim 6:17; Mark 4:19; Luke 21:34
- v15** — Heb 10:36; Gal 5:22-26; Col 1:10; Luke 6:45; Col 1:6
- v17** — Luke 12:2-3; Matt 10:26; Mark 4:22; Eccl 12:14; 1 Cor 4:5
- v18** — Matt 13:12; Mark 4:23-25; Luke 19:26; Matt 25:29; Prov 2:2-5
- v21** — Luke 11:27-28; Jas 1:22; John 13:17; 1 John 2:29; 3 John 1:11
- v22** — Matt 8:23-27; Mark 4:35-41; Mark 6:45; Luke 5:1; Matt 14:22
- v25** — Matt 8:26; Mark 4:40-41; Prov 30:4; John 11:40; Matt 14:31
- v43** — Mark 5:25-26; Matt 9:20-22; Lev 15:25-33; Luke 13:16
- v48** — Luke 7:50; Matt 9:22; Heb 4:2; Acts 14:9; Luke 17:19

Chapter 9

Jesus sends the twelve apostles out to preach and heal, then feeds five thousand men with five loaves and two fish. Peter confesses that Jesus is the Christ, and Jesus foretells His death and resurrection. Jesus is transfigured on a mountain before Peter, James, and John.

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| 1 | <i>Then he called his twelve disciples together, and gave them power and authority over all devils, and to cure diseases.</i> | He called the twelve together and gave them power and authority over all devils, and the ability to cure diseases. |
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| 2 | <i>And he sent them to preach the kingdom of God, and to heal the sick.</i> | He sent them out to preach the kingdom of God and to heal the sick. |
| 3 | <i>And he said unto them, Take nothing for your journey, neither staves, nor scrip, neither bread, neither money; neither have two coats apiece.</i> | He said to them, "Take nothing for the journey — no staff, no bag, no bread, no money, and no extra coat. |
| 4 | <i>And whatsoever house ye enter into, there abide, and thence depart.</i> | Whatever house You enter, stay there until You leave that place. |
| 5 | <i>And whosoever will not receive you, when ye go out of that city, shake off the very dust from your feet for a testimony against them.</i> | Wherever they do not receive You, shake off the dust from Your feet as a testimony against them when You leave that city." |
| 6 | <i>And they departed, and went through the towns, preaching the gospel, and healing every where.</i> | They left and went through the villages, preaching the gospel and healing everywhere. |
| 7 | <i>Now Herod the tetrarch heard of all that was done by him: and he was perplexed, because that it was said of some, that John was risen from the dead;</i> | Herod the tetrarch heard of all that was happening, and he was perplexed. Some were saying that John had risen from the dead, |
| 8 | <i>And of some, that Elias had appeared; and of others, that one of the old prophets was risen again.</i> | others that Elijah had appeared, and others that one of the ancient prophets had risen. |
| 9 | <i>And Herod said, John have I beheaded: but who is this, of whom I hear such things? And he desired to see him.</i> | Herod said, "John I had beheaded — but who is this about whom I hear such things?" He wanted to see Jesus. |
| 10 | <i>And the apostles, when they were returned, told him all that they had done. And he took them, and went aside privately into a desert place belonging to the city called Bethsaida.</i> | When the apostles returned, they told Him all they had done. He took them and withdrew privately to a place belonging to the city called Bethsaida. |

- 11 *And the people, when they knew it, followed him: and he received them, and spake unto them of the kingdom of God, and healed them that had need of healing.* When the crowds learned of it, they followed Him. He welcomed them and spoke to them about the kingdom of God, and healed those who had need of healing.
- 12 *And when the day began to wear away, then came the twelve, and said unto him, Send the multitude away, that they may go into the towns and country round about, and lodge, and get victuals: for we are here in a desert place.* As the day began to draw to a close, the twelve came to Him and said, "Send the crowd away so they can go into the surrounding villages and countryside to find food and lodging, because we are here in a deserted place."
- 13 *But he said unto them, Give ye them to eat. And they said, We have no more but five loaves and two fishes; except we should go and buy meat for all this people.* But He said to them, "You give them something to eat." They said, "We have no more than five loaves and two fish — unless we go and buy food for all this people."
- 14 *For they were about five thousand men. And he said to his disciples, Make them sit down by fifties in a company.* There were about five thousand men. He said to His disciples, "Have them sit down in groups of about fifty."
- 15 *And they did so, and made them all sit down.* They did so, and had everyone sit down.
- 16 *Then he took the five loaves and the two fishes, and looking up to heaven, he blessed them, and brake, and gave to the disciples to set before the multitude.* He took the five loaves and two fish, looked up to heaven, and gave thanks. He broke them and gave them to the disciples to set before the crowd.
- 17 *And they did eat, and were all filled: and there was taken up of fragments that remained to them twelve baskets.* They all ate and were filled, and twelve baskets of broken pieces were taken up as leftovers.
- 18 *And it came to pass, as he was alone praying, his disciples were with him: and he asked them, saying, Whom say the people that I am?* One day as He was praying alone with His disciples nearby, He asked them, "Who do the people say that I am?"

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| <p>19 <i>They answering said, John the Baptist; but some say, Elias; and others say, that one of the old prophets is risen again.</i></p> <p>20 <i>He said unto them, But whom say ye that I am? Peter answering said, The Christ of God.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And he straitly charged them, and commanded them to tell no man that thing;</i></p> <p>22 <i>Saying, The Son of man must suffer many things, and be rejected of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be slain, and be raised the third day.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And he said to them all, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.</i></p> <p>24 <i>For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: but whosoever will lose his life for my sake, the same shall save it.</i></p> <p>25 <i>For what is a man advantaged, if he gain the whole world, and lose himself, or be cast away?</i></p> <p>26 <i>For whosoever shall be ashamed of me and of my words, of him shall the Son of man be ashamed, when he shall come in his own glory, and in his Father's, and of the holy angels.</i></p> <p>27 <i>But I tell you of a truth, there be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>They answered, "John the Baptist. Others say Elijah, and others say that one of the ancient prophets has risen."</p> <p>He said to them, "But who do You say that I am?" Peter answered, "The Christ of God."</p> <p>He strictly charged them and commanded them to tell this to no one,</p> <p>saying, "The Son of Man must suffer many things and be rejected by the elders and chief priests and scribes. He must be killed, and on the third day be raised."</p> <p>He said to all, "If anyone wants to come after Me, let him deny himself and take up His cross daily and follow Me.</p> <p>For whoever wants to save his life will lose it. But whoever loses his life for My sake will save it.</p> <p>What does it profit a man if he gains the whole world but loses or forfeits Himself?</p> <p>Whoever is ashamed of Me and My words, of him the Son of Man will be ashamed when He comes in His own glory and in the glory of the Father and of the holy angels.</p> <p>But truly I tell You, there are some standing here who will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God."</p> |
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| <p>28 <i>And it came to pass about an eight days after these sayings, he took Peter and John and James, and went up into a mountain to pray.</i></p> | <p>About eight days after saying these things, He took Peter, John, and James and went up the mountain to pray.</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And as he prayed, the fashion of his countenance was altered, and his raiment was white and glistening.</i></p> | <p>As He prayed, the fashion of His countenance was altered, and His clothes became white and gleaming.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>And, behold, there talked with him two men, which were Moses and Elias:</i></p> | <p>Two men were talking with Him — Moses and Elijah —</p> |
| <p>31 <i>Who appeared in glory, and spake of his decease which he should accomplish at Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>who appeared in glory and spoke of His departure, which He was about to accomplish at Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with sleep: and when they were awake, they saw his glory, and the two men that stood with him.</i></p> | <p>Peter and those who were with him were heavy with sleep. When they became fully awake, they saw His glory and the two men standing with Him.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And it came to pass, as they departed from him, Peter said unto Jesus, Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias: not knowing what he said.</i></p> | <p>As the men were parting from Him, Peter said to Jesus, "Master, it is good for us to be here. Let us make three shelters — one for You, one for Moses, and one for Elijah" — not knowing what he was saying.</p> |
| <p>34 <i>While he thus spake, there came a cloud, and overshadowed them: and they feared as they entered into the cloud.</i></p> | <p>While He was saying this, a cloud came and overshadowed them, and they were afraid as they entered the cloud.</p> |
| <p>35 <i>And there came a voice out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him.</i></p> | <p>A voice came out of the cloud, saying, "This is My beloved Son — hear Him!"</p> |

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| <p>36 <i>And when the voice was past, Jesus was found alone. And they kept it close, and told no man in those days any of those things which they had seen.</i></p> | <p>When the voice had spoken, Jesus was found alone. They kept silent and told no one in those days anything of what they had seen.</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And it came to pass, that on the next day, when they were come down from the hill, much people met him.</i></p> | <p>On the next day, when they had come down from the mountain, a large crowd met Him.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And, behold, a man of the company cried out, saying, Master, I beseech thee, look upon my son: for he is mine only child.</i></p> | <p>A man in the crowd cried out, "Master, I beg you, look on my son, for He is my only child.</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And, lo, a spirit taketh him, and he suddenly crieth out; and it teareth him that he foameth again, and bruising him hardly departeth from him.</i></p> | <p>A spirit seizes Him and He suddenly cries out. It throws Him into convulsions and He foams at the mouth. It bruises Him and barely leaves Him.</p> |
| <p>40 <i>And I besought thy disciples to cast him out; and they could not.</i></p> | <p>I begged Your disciples to cast it out, but they could not."</p> |
| <p>41 <i>And Jesus answering said, O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you, and suffer you? Bring thy son hither.</i></p> | <p>Jesus answered, "O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with You and bear with You? Bring Your son here."</p> |
| <p>42 <i>And as he was yet a coming, the devil threw him down, and tare him. And Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, and healed the child, and delivered him again to his father.</i></p> | <p>As the boy was coming, the devil threw him down and convulsed him. Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, healed the boy, and gave him back to his father.</p> |
| <p>43 <i>And they were all amazed at the mighty power of God. But while they wondered every one at all things which Jesus did, he said unto his disciples,</i></p> | <p>They were all amazed at the majesty of God. While everyone was marveling at all Jesus did, He said to His disciples,</p> |

- 44 *Let these sayings sink down into your ears: for the Son of man shall be delivered into the hands of men.* "Let these words sink into Your ears: the Son of Man is going to be delivered into the hands of men."
- 45 *But they understood not this saying, and it was hid from them, that they perceived it not: and they feared to ask him of that saying.* But they did not understand what He said. It was hidden from them so they could not grasp it, and they were afraid to ask Him about it.
- 46 *Then there arose a reasoning among them, which of them should be greatest.* An argument arose among them about which of them was the greatest.
- 47 *And Jesus, perceiving the thought of their heart, took a child, and set him by him,* Jesus, knowing the thought of their hearts, took a child and set Him by His side.
- 48 *And said unto them, Whosoever shall receive this child in my name receiveth me: and whosoever shall receive me receiveth him that sent me: for he that is least among you all, the same shall be great.* He said to them, "Whoever receives this child in My name receives Me, and whoever receives Me receives the One who sent Me. For the one who is least among you all is the one who is great."
- 49 *And John answered and said, Master, we saw one casting out devils in thy name; and we forbid him, because he followeth not with us.* John answered, "Master, we saw someone casting out devils in your name, and we stopped Him because He does not follow with us."
- 50 *And Jesus said unto him, Forbid him not: for he that is not against us is for us.* Jesus said to Him, "Do not stop Him, for the one who is not against us is for us."
- 51 *And it came to pass, when the time was come that he should be received up, he stedfastly set his face to go to Jerusalem,* When the time drew near for Him to be taken up, He set His face steadfastly to go to Jerusalem.
- 52 *And sent messengers before his face: and they went, and entered into a village of the Samaritans, to make ready for him.* He sent messengers ahead of Him, and they went into a village of the Samaritans to prepare for Him.

- 53 *And they did not receive him, because his face was as though he would go to Jerusalem.* But the people did not receive him, because his face was set toward Jerusalem.
- 54 *And when his disciples James and John saw this, they said, Lord, wilt thou that we command fire to come down from heaven, and consume them, even as Elias did?* When His disciples James and John saw this, they said, "Lord, do you want us to call fire down from heaven and consume them, as Elijah did?"
- 55 *But he turned, and rebuked them, and said, Ye know not what manner of spirit ye are of.* But He turned and rebuked them and said, "You do not know what spirit you are of.
- 56 *For the Son of man is not come to destroy men's lives, but to save them. And they went to another village.* For the Son of Man has not come to destroy men's lives, but to save them." And they went to another village.
- 57 *And it came to pass, that, as they went in the way, a certain man said unto him, Lord, I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.* As they were going along the road, someone said to him, "Lord, I will follow you wherever You go."
- 58 *And Jesus said unto him, Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head.* Jesus said to Him, "Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head."
- 59 *And he said unto another, Follow me. But he said, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.* He said to another, "Follow Me." But He said, "Lord, let me first go and bury my father."
- 60 *Jesus said unto him, Let the dead bury their dead: but go thou and preach the kingdom of God.* Jesus said to Him, "Let the dead bury their own dead. But You go and proclaim the kingdom of God."
- 61 *And another also said, Lord, I will follow thee; but let me first go bid them farewell, which are at home at my house.* Another said, "Lord, I will follow You, but let me first say farewell to those at my home."

- 62 *And Jesus said unto him, No man, Jesus said to Him, "No one who puts
having put his hand to the plough, and his hand to the plow and looks back is
looking back, is fit for the kingdom of fit for the kingdom of God."
God.*

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

victuals (*VIT-ulz*) — Food provisions — supplies of food for a journey or army; also spelled 'victuals.'

Samaritans (*sah-MEHR-ih-tanz*) — People of mixed descent who lived in Samaria after the Assyrian conquest — Jews despised them as half-breeds who had corrupted their religion; Jesus's parable of the Good Samaritan shocked His audience.

Cross-References:

- v1** — John 14:12; Luke 10:19; Matt 16:19; Mark 16:17-18; Acts 4:30
v5 — Acts 13:51; Acts 18:6; Matt 10:14-15; Mark 6:11; Luke 10:16
v20 — Matt 16:15-17; John 4:42; John 7:41; John 4:29; John 20:31
v23 — Matt 10:38-39; Luke 14:26-27; Rom 8:13; John 12:25-26; Mark 8:34-38
v24 — Luke 17:33; John 12:25; Acts 20:23-24; Rev 2:10; Rev 12:11
v25 — Mark 8:36; Matt 16:26; Ps 49:6-8; Luke 12:19-21; Luke 4:5-7
v26 — Matt 10:32-33; 2 Tim 2:12; Luke 12:8-9; Rom 1:16; Matt 16:27
v35 — Luke 3:22; Matt 3:17; Acts 3:22-23; Deut 18:18-19; Heb 5:9
v49 — Mark 9:38-40; Num 11:27-29
v50 — Luke 11:23; Matt 12:30; Phil 1:15-18; 1 Cor 12:3; Luke 16:13
v56 — Matt 20:28; Rom 12:21; John 3:17; John 10:10; Luke 19:10
v62 — Phil 3:13; Heb 10:38; 2 Pet 2:20-22; Luke 17:31-32; Jas 1:6-8

Chapter 10

Jesus sends out seventy disciples ahead of Him into every city. He pronounces woe on Chorazin, Bethsaida, and Capernaum for their unbelief, and tells the parable of the Good Samaritan. He visits the home of Martha and Mary, commending Mary for choosing the better part.

- 1 *After these things the Lord appointed After this the Lord appointed seventy
other seventy also, and sent them two others and sent them out two by two
and two before his face into every city ahead of Him into every city and place
and place, whither he himself would where He Himself was about to come.
come.*

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| 2 <i>Therefore said he unto them, The harvest truly is great, but the labourers are few: pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he would send forth labourers into his harvest.</i> | He said to them, "The harvest is great, but the workers are few. Pray to the Lord of the harvest to send out workers into his harvest. |
| 3 <i>Go your ways: behold, I send you forth as lambs among wolves.</i> | Go — I send You out as lambs among wolves. |
| 4 <i>Carry neither purse, nor scrip, nor shoes: and salute no man by the way.</i> | Carry no purse, no bag, no sandals. Greet no one along the road. |
| 5 <i>And into whatsoever house ye enter, first say, Peace be to this house.</i> | Into whatever house You enter, first say, 'Peace be to this house.' |
| 6 <i>And if the son of peace be there, your peace shall rest upon it: if not, it shall turn to you again.</i> | If a son of peace is there, Your peace will rest on Him. If not, it will return to You. |
| 7 <i>And in the same house remain, eating and drinking such things as they give: for the labourer is worthy of his hire. Go not from house to house.</i> | Remain in the same house, eating and drinking what they provide, for the worker is worthy of His wages. Do not go from house to house. |
| 8 <i>And into whatsoever city ye enter, and they receive you, eat such things as are set before you:</i> | Whenever You enter a city and they receive You, eat what is set before You. |
| 9 <i>And heal the sick that are therein, and say unto them, The kingdom of God is come nigh unto you.</i> | Heal the sick there and say to them, 'The kingdom of God has come near to You.' |
| 10 <i>But into whatsoever city ye enter, and they receive you not, go your ways out into the streets of the same, and say,</i> | But when You enter a city and they do not receive You, go into its streets and say, |
| 11 <i>Even the very dust of your city, which cleaveth on us, we do wipe off against you: notwithstanding be ye sure of this, that the kingdom of God is come nigh unto you.</i> | 'Even the dust of Your city that clings to our feet we wipe off against You. Yet know this: the kingdom of God has come near.' |

- 12 *But I say unto you, that it shall be more tolerable in that day for Sodom, than for that city.* I tell You, it will be more bearable for Sodom on that day than for that city.
- 13 *Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida! for if the mighty works had been done in Tyre and Sidon, which have been done in you, they had a great while ago repented, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.* Woe to You, Chorazin! Woe to You, Bethsaida! For if the miracles done in You had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.
- 14 *But it shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment, than for you.* It will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment than for You.
- 15 *And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted to heaven, shalt be thrust down to hell.* And You, Capernaum — will You be lifted up to heaven? You will be brought down to hell.
- 16 *He that heareth you heareth me; and he that despiseth you despiseth me; and he that despiseth me despiseth him that sent me.* Whoever listens to you listens to Me. Whoever rejects you rejects Me. And whoever rejects Me rejects the One who sent Me."
- 17 *And the seventy returned again with joy, saying, Lord, even the devils are subject unto us through thy name.* The seventy returned with joy, saying, "Lord, even the devils are subject to us in Your name!"
- 18 *And he said unto them, I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven.* He said to them, "I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven.
- 19 *Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.* I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy. Nothing will hurt you by any means.
- 20 *Notwithstanding in this rejoice not, that the spirits are subject unto you; but rather rejoice, because your names are written in heaven.* Nevertheless, do not rejoice in this — that the spirits are subject to you — but rejoice that your names are written in heaven."

- 21 *In that hour Jesus rejoiced in spirit, and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes: even so, Father; for so it seemed good in thy sight.* At that moment Jesus rejoiced in the Spirit and said, "I thank You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that You have hidden these things from the wise and intelligent and revealed them to little children. Yes, Father, for this was Your good pleasure.
- 22 *All things are delivered to me of my Father: and no man knoweth who the Son is, but the Father; and who the Father is, but the Son, and he to whom the Son will reveal him.* All things have been handed over to Me by My Father. No one knows who the Son is except the Father, and no one knows who the Father is except the Son and anyone to whom the Son chooses to reveal him."
- 23 *And he turned him unto his disciples, and said privately, Blessed are the eyes which see the things that ye see:* Turning to His disciples, He said privately, "Blessed are the eyes that see what You see.
- 24 *For I tell you, that many prophets and kings have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.* For I tell You that many prophets and kings wanted to see what You see but did not see it, and to hear what You hear but did not hear it."
- 25 *And, behold, a certain lawyer stood up, and tempted him, saying, Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?* A certain lawyer stood up to test Him, saying, "Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?"
- 26 *He said unto him, What is written in the law? how readeest thou?* He said to Him, "What is written in the law? How do You read it?"
- 27 *And he answering said, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy strength, and with all thy mind; and thy neighbour as thyself.* He answered, "You shall love the Lord Your God with all Your heart, with all Your soul, with all Your strength, and with all Your mind; and Your neighbor as Yourself."
- 28 *And he said unto him, Thou hast answered right: this do, and thou shalt live.* He said to Him, "You have answered correctly. Do this and You will live."

- 29 *But he, willing to justify himself, said unto Jesus, And who is my neighbour?* But wanting to justify Himself, He said to Jesus, "And who is my neighbor?"
- 30 *And Jesus answering said, A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, which stripped him of his raiment, and wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead.* Jesus answered, "A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and He fell into the hands of robbers. They stripped Him of His clothes, beat Him, and left Him half dead.
- 31 *And by chance there came down a certain priest that way: and when he saw him, he passed by on the other side.* A priest happened to be going down that road. When he saw the man, he passed by on the other side.
- 32 *And likewise a Levite, when he was at the place, came and looked on him, and passed by on the other side.* Likewise a Levite, when he came to the place and saw him, passed by on the other side.
- 33 *But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him,* But a Samaritan, as he traveled, came to where the man was. When he saw him, he had compassion on him.
- 34 *And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him.* He went to him, bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. Then he put the man on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him.
- 35 *And on the morrow when he departed, he took out two pence, and gave them to the host, and said unto him, Take care of him; and whatsoever thou spendest more, when I come again, I will repay thee.* The next day he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper. He said, "Take care of him, and whatever more you spend I will repay you when I come back."
- 36 *Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?* Which of these three, do you think, proved to be a neighbor to the man who fell into the hands of the robbers?"

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| 37 | <i>And he said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.</i> | He said, "The one who showed mercy on him." Jesus said to Him, "Go and do likewise." |
| 38 | <i>Now it came to pass, as they went, that he entered into a certain village: and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house.</i> | As they went on their way, He entered a village. A woman named Martha received him into her house. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Martha** (MAR-thuh) — "lady" or "mistress of the house" — Sister of Mary and Lazarus of Bethany. She welcomed Jesus into her home and is known for her service.

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| 39 | <i>And she had a sister called Mary, which also sat at Jesus' feet, and heard his word.</i> | She had a sister called Mary, who sat at the Lord's feet and listened to his word. |
| 40 | <i>But Martha was cumbered about much serving, and came to him, and said, Lord, dost thou not care that my sister hath left me to serve alone? bid her therefore that she help me.</i> | But Martha was distracted with much serving. She came to Him and said, "Lord, do You not care that my sister has left me to serve alone? Tell her to help me." |
| 41 | <i>And Jesus answered and said unto her, Martha, Martha, thou art careful and troubled about many things:</i> | The Lord answered her, "Martha, Martha, you are worried and troubled about many things. |
| 42 | <i>But one thing is needful: and Mary hath chosen that good part, which shall not be taken away from her.</i> | But one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the better part, and it will not be taken away from her." |

Words in this chapter:

Jericho (JEHR-ih-ko) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Sodom (SOD-um) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v2 — Matt 9:36-38; John 4:35-38; 1 Cor 3:6-9; Mark 16:15; 1 Thess 5:12

v16 — John 13:20; 1 Thess 4:8; Matt 10:40; John 12:44; John 5:22-23

v17 — Mark 16:17; Luke 9:1; Rom 16:20; Luke 10:1; Luke 10:9
 v18 — Rev 12:7-9; Isa 14:12; John 12:31; Rev 9:1; John 16:11
 v19 — Ps 91:13; Mark 16:18; Rom 16:20; Acts 28:5; Rev 11:5
 v20 — Rev 20:15; Matt 7:22-23; Rev 20:12; Heb 12:23; Rev 21:27
 v22 — Matt 11:27; John 1:18; John 6:44-46; John 10:15; 2 Cor 4:6
 v25 — Matt 22:34-39; Luke 18:18; Acts 16:30-31
 v27 — Mark 12:30-31; Matt 22:37-40; Deut 6:5; Rom 13:9; Lev 19:18
 v38 — John 11:19-20; John 11:1-5; John 12:1-3; Luke 8:2-3; Acts 16:15
 v41 — Phil 4:6; Mark 4:19; Luke 21:34; Matt 6:25-34; Luke 8:14
 v42 — Ps 27:4; Ps 16:5-6; John 10:27-28; John 4:14; Ps 73:25

Chapter 11

Jesus teaches His disciples to pray and gives them a model prayer. He casts out a demon and refutes the accusation that He works by Beelzebub, declaring that a kingdom divided against itself cannot stand. He pronounces woes on the Pharisees and lawyers for their hypocrisy.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, that, as he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said unto him, Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples.</i></p> | <p>One day He was praying in a certain place. When He stopped, one of His disciples said to Him, "Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he said unto them, When ye pray, say, Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "When You pray, say: Our Father who is in heaven, hallowed be Your name. Your kingdom come. Your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Give us day by day our daily bread.</i></p> | <p>Give us day by day our daily bread.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And forgive us our sins; for we also forgive every one that is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation; but deliver us from evil.</i></p> | <p>Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves forgive everyone who is indebted to us. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And he said unto them, Which of you shall have a friend, and shall go unto him at midnight, and say unto him, Friend, lend me three loaves;</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "Which of You will have a friend, and will go to Him at midnight and say, 'Friend, lend me three loaves,</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For a friend of mine in his journey is come to me, and I have nothing to set before him?</i></p> | <p>for a friend of mine has come to me on a journey, and I have nothing to set before Him'?</p> |

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| <p>7 <i>And he from within shall answer and say, Trouble me not: the door is now shut, and my children are with me in bed; I cannot rise and give thee.</i></p> | <p>And He will answer from inside, 'Do not bother me. The door is already shut and my children are with me in bed. I cannot get up and give You anything.'</p> |
| <p>8 <i>I say unto you, Though he will not rise and give him, because he is his friend, yet because of his importunity he will rise and give him as many as he needeth.</i></p> | <p>I tell You, though He will not get up and give Him anything because He is His friend, yet because of His persistent asking He will rise and give Him as much as He needs.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And I say unto you, Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.</i></p> | <p>So I say to You: Ask, and it will be given to You. Seek, and You will find. Knock, and it will be opened to You.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.</i></p> | <p>For everyone who asks receives, and the one who seeks finds, and to the one who knocks it will be opened.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>If a son shall ask bread of any of you that is a father, will he give him a stone? or if he ask a fish, will he for a fish give him a serpent?</i></p> | <p>What father among You, if His son asks for bread, will give Him a stone? Or if He asks for a fish, will give Him a snake instead?</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Or if he shall ask an egg, will he offer him a scorpion?</i></p> | <p>Or if He asks for an egg, will give Him a scorpion?</p> |
| <p>13 <i>If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children: how much more shall your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to them that ask him?</i></p> | <p>If You then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to Your children, how much more will Your heavenly Father give the Holy Ghost to those who ask Him!"</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And he was casting out a devil, and it was dumb. And it came to pass, when the devil was gone out, the dumb spake; and the people wondered.</i></p> | <p>He was casting out a devil, and it was mute. When the devil had gone out, the mute man spoke, and the people marveled.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>But some of them said, He casteth out devils through Beelzebub the chief of the devils.</i></p> | <p>But some of them said, "He casts out devils by Beelzebub, the ruler of the devils."</p> |

- 16 *And others, tempting him, sought of him a sign from heaven.* Others, to test Him, demanded a sign from heaven.
- 17 *But he, knowing their thoughts, said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and a house divided against a house falleth.* But He knew their thoughts and said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to ruin, and a divided house falls.
- 18 *If Satan also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand? because ye say that I cast out devils through Beelzebub.* If Satan also is divided against himself, how will his kingdom stand? You say I cast out devils by Beelzebub.
- 19 *And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out? therefore shall they be your judges.* And if I cast out devils by Beelzebub, by whom do your sons cast them out? They will be your judges.
- 20 *But if I with the finger of God cast out devils, no doubt the kingdom of God is come upon you.* But if I cast out devils by the finger of God, then the kingdom of God has come upon you.
- 21 *When a strong man armed keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace:* When a strong man, fully armed, guards his own house, his possessions are safe.
- 22 *But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils.* But when one stronger than he comes and overpowers him, he takes away his full armor in which he trusted and divides his spoils.
- 23 *He that is not with me is against me: and he that gathereth not with me scattereth.* Whoever is not with Me is against Me, and whoever does not gather with Me scatters.
- 24 *When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest; and finding none, he saith, I will return unto my house whence I came out.* When the unclean spirit has gone out of a man, it passes through waterless places seeking rest, and finding none it says, 'I will return to my house from which I came.'

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| 25 | <i>And when he cometh, he findeth it swept and garnished.</i> | When it comes, it finds the house swept and in order. |
| 26 | <i>Then goeth he, and taketh to him seven other spirits more wicked than himself; and they enter in, and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first.</i> | Then it goes and brings seven other spirits more evil than itself, and they enter and live there. The final condition of that man is worse than the first." |
| 27 | <i>And it came to pass, as he spake these things, a certain woman of the company lifted up her voice, and said unto him, Blessed is the womb that bare thee, and the paps which thou hast sucked.</i> | As He said these things, a woman in the crowd raised her voice and said to him, "Blessed is the womb that bore You and the breasts that nursed You!" |
| 28 | <i>But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.</i> | But He said, "Blessed rather are those who hear the word of God and keep it!" |
| 29 | <i>And when the people were gathered thick together, he began to say, This is an evil generation: they seek a sign; and there shall no sign be given it, but the sign of Jonas the prophet.</i> | When the crowds were increasing, He began to say, "This is an evil generation. It seeks a sign, and no sign will be given to it except the sign of Jonah the prophet. |
| 30 | <i>For as Jonas was a sign unto the Ninevites, so shall also the Son of man be to this generation.</i> | For as Jonah was a sign to the Ninevites, so also will the Son of Man be to this generation. |
| 31 | <i>The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with the men of this generation, and condemn them: for she came from the utmost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here.</i> | The queen of the south will rise up in the judgment with the men of this generation and condemn them, for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon. And a greater than Solomon is here. |

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| <p>32 <i>The men of Nineve shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here.</i></p> | <p>The men of Nineveh will rise up in the judgment with this generation and condemn it, for they repented at the preaching of Jonah. And a greater than Jonah is here.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>No man, when he hath lighted a candle, putteth it in a secret place, neither under a bushel, but on a candlestick, that they which come in may see the light.</i></p> | <p>No one lights a lamp and puts it in a hidden place or under a basket, but on a stand, so that those who come in may see the light.</p> |
| <p>34 <i>The light of the body is the eye: therefore when thine eye is single, thy whole body also is full of light; but when thine eye is evil, thy body also is full of darkness.</i></p> | <p>Your eye is the lamp of your body. When your eye is healthy, your whole body is full of light. But when your eye is evil, your body is full of darkness.</p> |
| <p>35 <i>Take heed therefore that the light which is in thee be not darkness.</i></p> | <p>Be careful, then, that the light in you is not darkness.</p> |
| <p>36 <i>If thy whole body therefore be full of light, having no part dark, the whole shall be full of light, as when the bright shining of a candle doth give thee light.</i></p> | <p>If your whole body is full of light, with no dark part, then it will be completely bright, as when a lamp gives you light with its bright rays.</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And as he spake, a certain Pharisee besought him to dine with him: and he went in, and sat down to meat.</i></p> | <p>As He was speaking, a Pharisee asked Him to dine with him. He went in and reclined at the table.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And when the Pharisee saw it, he marvelled that he had not first washed before dinner.</i></p> | <p>The Pharisee was surprised to see that he did not first wash before dinner.</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And the Lord said unto him, Now do ye Pharisees make clean the outside of the cup and the platter; but your inward part is full of ravening and wickedness.</i></p> | <p>The Lord said to Him, "Now you Pharisees clean the outside of the cup and the dish, but your inside is full of greed and wickedness.</p> |

- 40 *Ye fools, did not he that made that which is without make that which is within also?* You fools! Did not He who made the outside also make the inside?
- 41 *But rather give alms of such things as ye have; and, behold, all things are clean unto you.* Give what is inside as charity, and all things will be clean for you.
- 42 *But woe unto you, Pharisees! for ye tithe the mint and rue and all manner of herbs, and pass over judgment and the love of God: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.* But woe to you Pharisees! For you tithe mint and rue and every herb, and neglect justice and the love of God. These you should have done, without leaving the others undone.
- 43 *Woe unto you, Pharisees! for ye love the uppermost seats in the synagogues, and greetings in the markets.* Woe to you Pharisees! For you love the best seats in the synagogues and greetings in the marketplaces.
- 44 *Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye are as graves which appear not, and the men that walk over them are not aware of them.* Woe to you! For you are like unmarked graves, and people walk over them without knowing it."
- 45 *Then answered one of the lawyers, and said unto him, Master, thus saying thou reproachest us also.* One of the lawyers answered Him, "Master, in saying these things You insult us too."
- 46 *And he said, Woe unto you also, ye lawyers! for ye lade men with burdens grievous to be borne, and ye yourselves touch not the burdens with one of your fingers.* He said, "Woe to you lawyers also! For you load people with burdens hard to bear, and you yourselves do not touch those burdens with even one of your fingers.
- 47 *Woe unto you! for ye build the sepulchres of the prophets, and your fathers killed them.* Woe to you! For you build the tombs of the prophets, and your fathers killed them.

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| <p>48 Truly ye bear witness that ye allow the deeds of your fathers: for they indeed killed them, and ye build their sepulchres.</p> | <p>So you are witnesses that you approve of your fathers' deeds — they killed the prophets, and you build their tombs.</p> |
| <p>49 Therefore also said the wisdom of God, I will send them prophets and apostles, and some of them they shall slay and persecute:</p> | <p>Therefore the wisdom of God said, 'I will send them prophets and apostles, and some of them they will kill and persecute,'</p> |
| <p>50 That the blood of all the prophets, which was shed from the foundation of the world, may be required of this generation;</p> | <p>so that the blood of all the prophets shed from the foundation of the world may be charged against this generation —</p> |
| <p>51 From the blood of Abel unto the blood of Zacharias, which perished between the altar and the temple: verily I say unto you, It shall be required of this generation.</p> | <p>from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zacharias who perished between the altar and the sanctuary. Truly I tell you, it will be charged against this generation.</p> |
| <p>52 Woe unto you, lawyers! for ye have taken away the key of knowledge: ye entered not in yourselves, and them that were entering in ye hindered.</p> | <p>Woe to you lawyers! For you have taken away the key of knowledge. You did not enter yourselves, and you hindered those who were entering."</p> |
| <p>53 And as he said these things unto them, the scribes and the Pharisees began to urge him vehemently, and to provoke him to speak of many things:</p> | <p>When He left there, the scribes and Pharisees began to press Him fiercely and to interrogate Him about many things,</p> |
| <p>54 Laying wait for him, and seeking to catch something out of his mouth, that they might accuse him.</p> | <p>lying in wait for Him and seeking to catch something from His mouth to accuse Him.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

- Abel** (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.
- Solomon** (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (*shalom*).
- Zacharias** (*zak-ah-RY-as*) — A priest and the father of John the Baptist — struck mute when he doubted the angel's announcement; his name means 'the LORD remembers.'
- Nineveh** (*NIN-eh-veh*) — The capital of Assyria — the great city to which Jonah was sent; when he preached, the whole city repented; it was later destroyed as Nahum prophesied.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ps 19:14; Rom 8:26-27; Luke 22:39-45; Jude 1:20; Luke 6:12
- v2 — Matt 6:6-15; Eccl 5:2; Ps 72:18-19; Rev 15:4; 1 Thess 3:11-13
- v8 — Gen 32:26; Luke 18:1-8; Col 4:12; Rom 15:30; Matt 15:22-28
- v9 — Mark 11:24; John 16:23-24; Matt 21:22; John 15:16; John 15:7
- v10 — Jas 4:3; Lam 3:54-58; Lam 3:18; Ps 31:22; Jas 5:11
- v13 — Matt 7:11; Isa 44:3-4; Rom 8:32; John 4:10; Prov 1:23
- v17 — Mark 3:23-27; Matt 12:25-29; Isa 19:2-3; John 2:25; Isa 9:20-21
- v28 — Luke 6:47-48; Luke 8:21; Ps 112:1; Jas 1:21-25; John 13:17
- v34 — Matt 6:22-23; Acts 26:18; Rom 11:8-10; Ps 119:18; Jer 5:21
- v35 — Prov 16:25; 2 Pet 1:9; Jas 3:13-17; 1 Cor 1:19-21; Rom 1:22
- v51 — 2 Chr 24:20-22; Heb 11:4; Matt 23:35; Gen 4:8-11; Zech 1:1
- v52 — Matt 23:13; Mal 2:7; Acts 4:17-18; Luke 11:45-46; John 9:24-34

Chapter 12

Jesus warns His disciples against the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy, and teaches them not to fear those who can kill the body. He tells the parable of the rich fool who stores up treasure for himself but is not rich toward God, and urges His followers to be watchful and ready for the Son of man's coming.

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| 1 <i>In the mean time, when there were gathered together an innumerable multitude of people, insomuch that they trode one upon another, he began to say unto his disciples first of all, Beware ye of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy.</i> | When countless thousands of people had gathered, so that they were trampling one another, He began to say to His disciples first, "Beware of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy. |
| 2 <i>For there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; neither hid, that shall not be known.</i> | For there is nothing covered that will not be revealed, and nothing hidden that will not be known. |

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| <p>3 <i>Therefore whatsoever ye have spoken in darkness shall be heard in the light; and that which ye have spoken in the ear in closets shall be proclaimed upon the housetops.</i></p> | <p>Therefore whatever You have said in the dark will be heard in the light, and what You have whispered behind closed doors will be proclaimed from the rooftops.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And I say unto you my friends, Be not afraid of them that kill the body, and after that have no more that they can do.</i></p> | <p>I tell You, My friends: do not be afraid of those who kill the body, and after that can do nothing more.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>But I will forewarn you whom ye shall fear: Fear him, which after he hath killed hath power to cast into hell; yea, I say unto you, Fear him.</i></p> | <p>But I will warn You whom to fear: fear Him who, after killing, has authority to cast into hell. Yes, I tell You, fear Him.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — *The place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one English word — "hell" — for the Hebrew Sheol and the Greek Hades and Gehenna. Here it refers to God's final judgment.*

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| <p>6 <i>Are not five sparrows sold for two farthings, and not one of them is forgotten before God?</i></p> | <p>Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? Yet not one of them is forgotten before God.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>But even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not therefore: ye are of more value than many sparrows.</i></p> | <p>Indeed, the very hairs of Your head are all numbered. Do not be afraid — you are worth more than many sparrows.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Also I say unto you, Whosoever shall confess me before men, him shall the Son of man also confess before the angels of God:</i></p> | <p>I tell You, whoever acknowledges Me before men, the Son of Man will also acknowledge before the angels of God.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>But he that denieth me before men shall be denied before the angels of God.</i></p> | <p>But the one who denies Me before men will be denied before the angels of God.</p> |

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| <p>10 <i>And whosoever shall speak a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but unto him that blasphemeth against the Holy Ghost it shall not be forgiven.</i></p> | <p>Whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven. But the one who blasphemes against the Holy Ghost will not be forgiven.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>And when they bring you unto the synagogues, and unto magistrates, and powers, take ye no thought how or what thing ye shall answer, or what ye shall say:</i></p> | <p>When they bring You before synagogues and rulers and authorities, do not worry about how You will defend Yourself or what You will say.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>For the Holy Ghost shall teach you in the same hour what ye ought to say.</i></p> | <p>For the Holy Ghost will teach You in that very hour what You ought to say."</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And one of the company said unto him, Master, speak to my brother, that he divide the inheritance with me.</i></p> | <p>Someone in the crowd said to him, "Master, tell my brother to divide the inheritance with me."</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And he said unto him, Man, who made me a judge or a divider over you?</i></p> | <p>He said to Him, "Man, who appointed Me a judge or arbitrator over You?"</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And he said unto them, Take heed, and beware of covetousness: for a man's life consisteth not in the abundance of the things which he possesseth.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "Take care and be on guard against covetousness, for a man's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And he spake a parable unto them, saying, The ground of a certain rich man brought forth plentifully:</i></p> | <p>He told them a parable: "The land of a certain rich man produced a great harvest.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And he thought within himself, saying, What shall I do, because I have no room where to bestow my fruits?</i></p> | <p>He reasoned to Himself, 'What shall I do? I have nowhere to store my crops.'</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And he said, This will I do: I will pull down my barns, and build greater; and there will I bestow all my fruits and my goods.</i></p> | <p>He said, 'This is what I will do: I will tear down my barns and build bigger ones, and there I will store all my grain and my goods.</p> |

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| <p>19 <i>And I will say to my soul, Soul, thou hast much goods laid up for many years; take thine ease, eat, drink, and be merry.</i></p> | <p>Then I will say to my soul, "Soul, You have many goods stored up for many years. Take Your ease — eat, drink, and be merry."</p> |
| <p>20 <i>But God said unto him, Thou fool, this night thy soul shall be required of thee: then whose shall those things be, which thou hast provided?</i></p> | <p>But God said to Him, 'Fool! This night Your soul will be required of You. Then whose will those things be that You have stored up?'</p> |
| <p>21 <i>So is he that layeth up treasure for himself, and is not rich toward God.</i></p> | <p>That is what happens to the one who stores up treasure for himself and is not rich toward God."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And he said unto his disciples, Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat; neither for the body, what ye shall put on.</i></p> | <p>He said to His disciples, "Therefore I tell You, do not worry about Your life — what You will eat — or about Your body — what You will wear.</p> |
| <p>23 <i>The life is more than meat, and the body is more than raiment.</i></p> | <p>Life is more than food, and the body more than clothing.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>Consider the ravens: for they neither sow nor reap; which neither have storehouse nor barn; and God feedeth them: how much more are ye better than the fowls?</i></p> | <p>Consider the ravens — they neither sow nor reap. They have no storehouse or barn, yet God feeds them. How much more are You worth than birds!</p> |
| <p>25 <i>And which of you with taking thought can add to his stature one cubit?</i></p> | <p>Which of You by worrying can add a single hour to His life?</p> |
| <p>26 <i>If ye then be not able to do that thing which is least, why take ye thought for the rest?</i></p> | <p>If then You are not able to do even a very small thing, why do You worry about the rest?</p> |
| <p>27 <i>Consider the lilies how they grow: they toil not, they spin not; and yet I say unto you, that Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.</i></p> | <p>Consider how the lilies grow. They neither toil nor spin. Yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not dressed like one of these.</p> |

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| <p>28 <i>If then God so clothe the grass, which is to day in the field, and to morrow is cast into the oven; how much more will he clothe you, O ye of little faith?</i></p> | <p>If God clothes the grass of the field — which is here today and tomorrow is thrown into the furnace — how much more will He clothe you, O you of little faith!</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And seek not ye what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink, neither be ye of doubtful mind.</i></p> | <p>Do not seek what you will eat or what you will drink, and do not be anxious.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>For all these things do the nations of the world seek after: and your Father knoweth that ye have need of these things.</i></p> | <p>For all the nations of the world seek after these things, and your Father knows that you need them.</p> |
| <p>31 <i>But rather seek ye the kingdom of God; and all these things shall be added unto you.</i></p> | <p>Instead, seek His kingdom, and these things will be added to you.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>Fear not, little flock; for it is your Father's good pleasure to give you the kingdom.</i></p> | <p>Do not be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father's good pleasure to give you the kingdom.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>Sell that ye have, and give alms; provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure in the heavens that faileth not, where no thief approacheth, neither moth corrupteth.</i></p> | <p>Sell your possessions and give to the poor. Provide yourselves with purses that do not grow old — a treasure in the heavens that does not fail, where no thief comes near and no moth destroys.</p> |
| <p>34 <i>For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.</i></p> | <p>For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.</p> |
| <p>35 <i>Let your loins be girded about, and your lights burning;</i></p> | <p>Let your loins be girded, and your lamps burning,</p> |
| <p>36 <i>And ye yourselves like unto men that wait for their lord, when he will return from the wedding; that when he cometh and knocketh, they may open unto him immediately.</i></p> | <p>Be like men who are waiting for their master to return from a wedding feast, so that when he comes and knocks they can open the door for him immediately.</p> |

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| <p>37 <i>Blessed are those servants, whom the lord when he cometh shall find watching: verily I say unto you, that he shall gird himself, and make them to sit down to meat, and will come forth and serve them.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And if he shall come in the second watch, or come in the third watch, and find them so, blessed are those servants.</i></p> <p>39 <i>And this know, that if the goodman of the house had known what hour the thief would come, he would have watched, and not have suffered his house to be broken through.</i></p> <p>40 <i>Be ye therefore ready also: for the Son of man cometh at an hour when ye think not.</i></p> <p>41 <i>Then Peter said unto him, Lord, speakest thou this parable unto us, or even to all?</i></p> <p>42 <i>And the Lord said, Who then is that faithful and wise steward, whom his lord shall make ruler over his household, to give them their portion of meat in due season?</i></p> <p>43 <i>Blessed is that servant, whom his lord when he cometh shall find so doing.</i></p> <p>44 <i>Of a truth I say unto you, that he will make him ruler over all that he hath.</i></p> | <p>Blessed are those servants whom the master finds awake when he comes. Truly I tell you, he will dress himself for service, have them recline at the table, and come and serve them.</p> <p>If he comes in the second or third watch and finds them ready — blessed are those servants.</p> <p>Know this: if the master of the house had known at what hour the thief was coming, he would have kept watch and not let his house be broken into.</p> <p>You also must be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour You do not expect."</p> <p>Peter said, "Lord, are you telling this parable to us or to everyone?"</p> <p>The Lord said, "Who then is the faithful and wise manager whom the master will put in charge of his household staff, to give them their portion at the right time?</p> <p>Blessed is that servant whom the master finds doing this when he comes.</p> <p>Truly I tell you, he will put him in charge of all his possessions.</p> |
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- 45 *But and if that servant say in his heart, My lord delayeth his coming; and shall begin to beat the menservants and maidens, and to eat and drink, and to be drunken;* But if that servant says in his heart, 'My master is taking a long time to come,' and begins to beat the menservants and maidservants, and to eat and drink and get drunk,
- 46 *The lord of that servant will come in a day when he looketh not for him, and at an hour when he is not aware, and will cut him in sunder, and will appoint him his portion with the unbelievers.* the master of that servant will come on a day he does not expect and at an hour he does not know. He will cut him to pieces and assign him a place with the unbelievers.
- 47 *And that servant, which knew his lord's will, and prepared not himself, neither did according to his will, shall be beaten with many stripes.* That servant who knew his master's will but did not prepare himself or act according to his will shall be beaten with many blows.
- 48 *But he that knew not, and did commit things worthy of stripes, shall be beaten with few stripes. For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required: and to whom men have committed much, of him they will ask the more.* But the one who did not know and did things deserving punishment will be beaten with few blows. From everyone to whom much is given, much will be required. From the one entrusted with much, even more will be asked.
- 49 *I am come to send fire on the earth; and what will I, if it be already kindled?* I have come to bring fire on the earth, and how I wish it were already kindled!
- 50 *But I have a baptism to be baptized with; and how am I straitened till it be accomplished!* I have a baptism to undergo, and how great is My distress until it is accomplished!
- 51 *Suppose ye that I am come to give peace on earth? I tell you, Nay; but rather division:* Do you think I came to bring peace on earth? No, I tell you, but rather division.
- 52 *For from henceforth there shall be five in one house divided, three against two, and two against three.* From now on, five in one household will be divided — three against two, and two against three.

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| <p>53 <i>The father shall be divided against the son, and the son against the father; the mother against the daughter, and the daughter against the mother; the mother in law against her daughter in law, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.</i></p> | <p>Father will be divided against son and son against father, mother against daughter and daughter against mother, mother-in-law against daughter-in-law and daughter-in-law against mother-in-law.</p> |
| <p>54 <i>And he said also to the people, When ye see a cloud rise out of the west, straightway ye say, There cometh a shower; and so it is.</i></p> | <p>He also said to the crowds, "When you see a cloud rising in the west, you immediately say, 'A shower is coming,' and so it happens.</p> |
| <p>55 <i>And when ye see the south wind blow, ye say, There will be heat; and it cometh to pass.</i></p> | <p>When you see the south wind blowing, you say, 'There will be heat,' and it happens.</p> |
| <p>56 <i>Ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky and of the earth; but how is it that ye do not discern this time?</i></p> | <p>You hypocrites! You know how to read the appearance of earth and sky, but why do you not know how to read this present time?</p> |
| <p>57 <i>Yea, and why even of yourselves judge ye not what is right?</i></p> | <p>Why do you not judge for yourselves what is right?</p> |
| <p>58 <i>When thou goest with thine adversary to the magistrate, as thou art in the way, give diligence that thou mayest be delivered from him; lest he hale thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and the officer cast thee into prison.</i></p> | <p>When you go with your accuser before a magistrate, try to settle with him on the way, or he may drag you before the judge, the judge hand you over to the officer, and the officer throw you into prison.</p> |
| <p>59 <i>I tell thee, thou shalt not depart thence, till thou hast paid the very last mite.</i></p> | <p>I tell you, you will not get out until you have paid the very last penny."</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

v2 — Mark 4:22; Luke 8:17; 2 Cor 5:10; Eccl 12:14; Matt 10:26-33

v5 — 2 Pet 2:4; Matt 10:28; Rev 14:7; Ps 9:17; Heb 10:31

v8 — Matt 10:32-33; 1 John 2:23; Rom 10:9-10; 2 Tim 2:12; Luke 15:10

v12 — Luke 21:15; Matt 10:20; Acts 4:8; Acts 6:10; Ex 4:11

v15 — Heb 13:5; 1 Tim 6:6-10; Ps 119:36-37; Prov 16:16; Prov 15:16

v31 — Matt 6:33; Heb 13:5; Ps 34:9; 1 Kgs 3:11-13; John 6:27

v32 — Heb 12:28; 1 Pet 1:3-5; Rev 1:6; Phil 2:13; Luke 10:21

v33 — Matt 19:21; Acts 4:34-35; Acts 2:45; Luke 18:22; Matt 6:19-21

v35 — 1 Pet 1:13; Eph 6:14; Matt 25:4-10; Matt 5:16; Matt 25:1

v40 — 1 Thess 5:6; Matt 25:13; Rom 13:11; Matt 24:44; 2 Pet 3:12-14

v47 — Jas 4:17; John 9:41; John 12:48; John 15:22-24; Deut 25:2-3

v48 — Jas 3:1; Lev 5:17; Luke 16:10-12; Matt 25:14-29; John 15:22

Chapter 13

Jesus warns that unless the people repent, they will likewise perish, and He tells the parable of the barren fig tree. He heals a woman bent over for eighteen years on the Sabbath, teaches about the narrow gate, and laments over Jerusalem.

- 1 *There were present at that season some that told him of the Galilaeans, whose blood Pilate had mingled with their sacrifices.* At that time, some people told Jesus about the Galileans whose blood Pilate had mixed with their sacrifices.
- 2 *And Jesus answering said unto them, Suppose ye that these Galilaeans were sinners above all the Galilaeans, because they suffered such things?* Jesus answered them, "Do You think those Galileans were worse sinners than all other Galileans, because they suffered this way?"
- 3 *I tell you, Nay: but, except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.* No, I tell You. But unless You repent, You will all likewise perish.

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| <p>4 <i>Or those eighteen, upon whom the tower in Siloam fell, and slew them, think ye that they were sinners above all men that dwelt in Jerusalem?</i></p> <p>5 <i>I tell you, Nay: but, except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.</i></p> <p>6 <i>He spake also this parable; A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard; and he came and sought fruit thereon, and found none.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Then said he unto the dresser of his vineyard, Behold, these three years I come seeking fruit on this fig tree, and find none: cut it down; why cumbereth it the ground?</i></p> <p>8 <i>And he answering said unto him, Lord, let it alone this year also, till I shall dig about it, and dung it:</i></p> <p>9 <i>And if it bear fruit, well: and if not, then after that thou shalt cut it down.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the sabbath.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And, behold, there was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up herself.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And when Jesus saw her, he called her to him, and said unto her, Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And he laid his hands on her: and immediately she was made straight, and glorified God.</i></p> | <p>Or those eighteen on whom the tower of Siloam fell and killed them — do You think they were worse sinners than all others who lived in Jerusalem?</p> <p>No, I tell You. But unless You repent, You will all likewise perish."</p> <p>He also told this parable: "A man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard. He came looking for fruit on it and found none.</p> <p>He said to the keeper of his vineyard, 'Three years now I have come looking for fruit on this fig tree and found none. Cut it down. Why should it use up the ground?'</p> <p>The keeper answered Him, 'Sir, leave it alone this year also, until I dig around it and fertilize it.</p> <p>If it bears fruit next year, good. If not, then cut it down.' "</p> <p>He was teaching in one of the synagogues on the Sabbath.</p> <p>There was a woman who had a spirit of illness for eighteen years. She was bent double and could not straighten up at all.</p> <p>When Jesus saw her, He called her over and said to her, "Woman, You are set free from Your illness."</p> <p>He laid His hands on her, and immediately she stood up straight and praised God.</p> |
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- 14 *And the ruler of the synagogue answered with indignation, because that Jesus had healed on the sabbath day, and said unto the people, There are six days in which men ought to work: in them therefore come and be healed, and not on the sabbath day.* The ruler of the synagogue was angry because Jesus had healed on the Sabbath. He said to the people, "There are six days in which people ought to work. Come on those days and be healed — not on the Sabbath day."
- 15 *The Lord then answered him, and said, Thou hypocrite, doth not each one of you on the sabbath loose his ox or his ass from the stall, and lead him away to watering?* The Lord answered Him, "You hypocrite! Does not each of You on the Sabbath untie His ox or his donkey from the stall and lead it away to water?"
- 16 *And ought not this woman, being a daughter of Abraham, whom Satan hath bound, lo, these eighteen years, be loosed from this bond on the sabbath day?* Should not this woman, a daughter of Abraham whom Satan has bound for eighteen years, be set free from this bond on the Sabbath day?"
- 17 *And when he had said these things, all his adversaries were ashamed: and all the people rejoiced for all the glorious things that were done by him.* When He said this, all His opponents were put to shame. All the people rejoiced at the wonderful things he was doing.
- 18 *Then said he, Unto what is the kingdom of God like? and whereunto shall I resemble it?* Then He said, "What is the kingdom of God like? What shall I compare it to?"
- 19 *It is like a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and cast into his garden; and it grew, and waxed a great tree; and the fowls of the air lodged in the branches of it.* It is like a grain of mustard seed that a man took and planted in his garden. It grew and became a great tree, and the birds of the air made nests in its branches."
- 20 *And again he said, Whereunto shall I liken the kingdom of God?* Again He said, "What shall I compare the kingdom of God to?"
- 21 *It is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.* It is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into three measures of flour until the whole batch was leavened."

- 22 *And he went through the cities and villages, teaching, and journeying toward Jerusalem.* He traveled through towns and villages, teaching as He made His way to Jerusalem.
- 23 *Then said one unto him, Lord, are there few that be saved? And he said unto them,* Someone asked him, "Lord, will only a few be saved?" He said to them,
- 24 *Strive to enter in at the strait gate: for many, I say unto you, will seek to enter in, and shall not be able.* "Strive to enter through the narrow gate. Many, I tell you, will try to enter and will not be able.
- 25 *When once the master of the house is risen up, and hath shut to the door, and ye begin to stand without, and to knock at the door, saying, Lord, Lord, open unto us; and he shall answer and say unto you, I know you not whence ye are:* Once the master of the house rises and shuts the door, you will stand outside and knock, saying, 'Lord, Lord, open to us.' He will answer, 'I do not know where you are from.'
- 26 *Then shall ye begin to say, We have eaten and drunk in thy presence, and thou hast taught in our streets.* Then you will say, 'We ate and drank in Your presence. You taught in our streets.'
- 27 *But he shall say, I tell you, I know you not whence ye are; depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity.* He will say, 'I tell you, I do not know where you are from. Depart from Me, all you workers of iniquity.'

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than the word "sin." Iniquity points to the corruption beneath the sinful act itself, not just the act.

- 28 *There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth, when ye shall see Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, and all the prophets, in the kingdom of God, and you yourselves thrust out.* There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth when you see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God — but you yourselves cast out.
- 29 *And they shall come from the east, and from the west, and from the north, and from the south, and shall sit down in the kingdom of God.* People will come from east and west, from north and south, and will take their places at the feast in the kingdom of God.

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| 30 | <i>And, behold, there are last which shall be first, and there are first which shall be last.</i> | Indeed, there are those who are last who will be first, and those who are first who will be last." |
| 31 | <i>The same day there came certain of the Pharisees, saying unto him, Get thee out, and depart hence: for Herod will kill thee.</i> | At that very hour some Pharisees came and said to Him, "Leave this place and go away, for Herod wants to kill you." |
| 32 | <i>And he said unto them, Go ye, and tell that fox, Behold, I cast out devils, and I do cures to day and to morrow, and the third day I shall be perfected.</i> | He said to them, "Go tell that fox, 'I cast out demons and perform healings today and tomorrow, and on the third day I will reach My goal.' |
| 33 | <i>Nevertheless I must walk to day, and to morrow, and the day following: for it cannot be that a prophet perish out of Jerusalem.</i> | Still, I must go on today and tomorrow and the next day — for it cannot be that a prophet should perish away from Jerusalem. |
| 34 | <i>O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, which killest the prophets, and stonest them that are sent unto thee; how often would I have gathered thy children together, as a hen doth gather her brood under her wings, and ye would not!</i> | O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kill the prophets and stone those sent to you! How often I wanted to gather your children together as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings — but you would not! |
| 35 | <i>Behold, your house is left unto you desolate: and verily I say unto you, Ye shall not see me, until the time come when ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.</i> | Your house is left to you desolate. Truly I say to you, you will not see Me until you say, 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord.' " |

Words in this chapter:

Pilate (PY-lat) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Cross-References:

- v3** — Acts 3:19; Matt 3:2; Acts 2:38-40; Rev 2:21-22; Luke 13:5
v6 — John 15:16; Isa 5:1-4; Gal 5:22; Matt 21:19-20; Jer 2:21
v7 — Matt 7:19; Luke 3:9; John 15:6; John 15:2; Rom 2:4-5
v8 — Rom 10:1; 2 Pet 3:9; Joel 2:17; Rom 11:14; Jer 15:1

v11 — Luke 8:2; Luke 13:16; Luke 8:27; Luke 8:43; Ps 6:2
 v12 — Ps 107:20; Matt 8:16; Luke 6:8-10; Joel 3:10; Luke 13:16
 v23 — Matt 7:14; Matt 22:14; John 21:21-22; Matt 20:16; Luke 12:13-15
 v24 — Matt 7:13-14; 2 Pet 1:10; 1 Cor 9:24-27; Heb 4:11; Luke 21:36
 v27 — Ps 6:8; Matt 25:41; Matt 7:22-23; Ps 119:115; Ps 1:6
 v30 — Matt 19:30; Matt 21:28-31; Mark 10:31; Matt 20:16; Matt 3:9-10
 v34 — Matt 23:37-39; Deut 32:11-12; Isa 30:15; Acts 7:52; Luke 19:41-42
 v35 — Ps 118:26; Mark 11:9-10; John 12:13; Matt 21:9

Chapter 14

Jesus heals a man with dropsy on the Sabbath in the house of a Pharisee and teaches about humility at feasts. He tells the parable of the great supper, where those first invited refuse and the poor and outcast are brought in, and warns that those who follow Him must count the cost.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, as he went into the house of one of the chief Pharisees to eat bread on the sabbath day, that they watched him.</i> | One Sabbath, Jesus went to eat in the house of a prominent Pharisee, and they were watching Him closely. |
| 2 | <i>And, behold, there was a certain man before him which had the dropsy.</i> | There in front of Him was a man who had dropsy. |
| 3 | <i>And Jesus answering spake unto the lawyers and Pharisees, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath day?</i> | Jesus asked the lawyers and Pharisees, "Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath day, or not?" |
| 4 | <i>And they held their peace. And he took him, and healed him, and let him go;</i> | They were silent. So He took the man, healed him, and sent him away. |
| 5 | <i>And answered them, saying, Which of you shall have an ass or an ox fallen into a pit, and will not straightway pull him out on the sabbath day?</i> | Then He said to them, "Which of you, if your ass or your ox falls into a pit on the Sabbath day, will not immediately pull him out?" |
| 6 | <i>And they could not answer him again to these things.</i> | They could not reply to this. |
| 7 | <i>And he put forth a parable to those which were bidden, when he marked how they chose out the chief rooms; saying unto them,</i> | When He noticed how the guests chose the places of honor, He told them a parable. |

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| <p>8 <i>When thou art bidden of any man to a wedding, sit not down in the highest room; lest a more honourable man than thou be bidden of him;</i></p> | <p>"When someone invites you to a wedding feast, do not sit down in the place of honor. A more distinguished man than you may have been invited.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And he that bade thee and him come and say to thee, Give this man place; and thou begin with shame to take the lowest room.</i></p> | <p>The host who invited both of you will come and say, 'Give this man your seat.' Then you will have to take the lowest seat in shame.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>But when thou art bidden, go and sit down in the lowest room; that when he that bade thee cometh, he may say unto thee, Friend, go up higher: then shalt thou have worship in the presence of them that sit at meat with thee.</i></p> | <p>But when you are invited, go and sit in the lowest place. Then your host will come and say, 'Friend, move up to a better place.' That will bring you honor in front of everyone at the table.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>For whosoever exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.</i></p> | <p>For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and everyone who humbles himself will be exalted."</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Then said he also to him that bade him, When thou makest a dinner or a supper, call not thy friends, nor thy brethren, neither thy kinsmen, nor thy rich neighbours; lest they also bid thee again, and a recompence be made thee.</i></p> | <p>He also said to the man who had invited him, "When you give a dinner or a supper, do not invite your friends, your brothers, your relatives, or your rich neighbors. They may invite you back and repay you.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame, the blind:</i></p> | <p>But when you give a feast, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And thou shalt be blessed; for they cannot recompense thee: for thou shalt be recompensed at the resurrection of the just.</i></p> | <p>You will be blessed, because they cannot repay you. You will be repaid at the resurrection of the righteous."</p> |

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| <p>15 <i>And when one of them that sat at meat with him heard these things, he said unto him, Blessed is he that shall eat bread in the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>When one of those at the table heard this, He said to Jesus, "Blessed is the one who will eat bread in the kingdom of God!"</p> |
| <p>16 <i>Then said he unto him, A certain man made a great supper, and bade many:</i></p> | <p>Jesus replied, "A man gave a great banquet and invited many people.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And sent his servant at supper time to say to them that were bidden, Come; for all things are now ready.</i></p> | <p>At the time of the banquet, He sent His servant to tell those invited, 'Come, for everything is now ready.'</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And they all with one consent began to make excuse. The first said unto him, I have bought a piece of ground, and I must needs go and see it: I pray thee have me excused.</i></p> | <p>But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said, 'I have bought a field, and I must go see it. Please excuse me.'</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And another said, I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to prove them: I pray thee have me excused.</i></p> | <p>Another said, 'I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I am going to try them out. Please excuse me.'</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And another said, I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come.</i></p> | <p>Another said, 'I have just married a wife, and so I cannot come.'</p> |
| <p>21 <i>So that servant came, and shewed his lord these things. Then the master of the house being angry said to his servant, Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in hither the poor, and the maimed, and the halt, and the blind.</i></p> | <p>The servant came and reported this to his master. The master of the house became angry and said to His servant, 'Go out quickly into the streets and alleys of the city and bring in the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind.'</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And the servant said, Lord, it is done as thou hast commanded, and yet there is room.</i></p> | <p>The servant said, 'Sir, what you commanded has been done, and there is still room.'</p> |
| <p>23 <i>And the lord said unto the servant, Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled.</i></p> | <p>The master said to the servant, 'Go out to the roads and country lanes and make them come in, so that my house will be full.'</p> |

- 24 *For I say unto you, That none of those men which were bidden shall taste of my supper.* I tell You, not one of those who were invited will taste my banquet.' "
- 25 *And there went great multitudes with him: and he turned, and said unto them,* Large crowds were traveling with Jesus. He turned and said to them,
- 26 *If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.* "If anyone comes to Me and does not love Me more than his father and mother, his wife and children, His brothers and sisters — yes, even His own life — he cannot be My disciple.
- 27 *And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple.* Whoever does not carry his cross and follow Me cannot be My disciple.
- 28 *For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?* Which of You, wanting to build a tower, does not first sit down and count the cost — whether He has enough to complete it?
- 29 *Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him,* Otherwise, if He lays the foundation and cannot finish, everyone who sees it will mock Him,
- 30 *Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish.* saying, 'This man began to build and was not able to finish.'
- 31 *Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand?* Or what king, going to war against another king, does not first sit down and consider whether he can meet the one coming against him with twenty thousand — when he himself has only ten thousand?
- 32 *Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace.* If he cannot, he sends a delegation while the other king is still far away and asks for terms of peace.

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| 33 | <i>So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.</i> | In the same way, any one of you who does not give up everything he has cannot be My disciple. |
| 34 | <i>Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned?</i> | Salt is good. But if salt loses its flavor, how can it be made salty again? |
| 35 | <i>It is neither fit for the land, nor yet for the dunghill; but men cast it out. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.</i> | It is fit neither for the soil nor for the manure pile — it is thrown out. Whoever has ears to hear, let them hear." |

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v11 — Luke 18:14; Matt 23:12; Prov 29:23; Jas 4:6; Ps 138:6
- v12 — Jas 2:1-6; Matt 5:46; Luke 6:32-36; Prov 22:16; Prov 14:20
- v13 — Luke 14:21; Isa 58:10; Isa 58:7; Prov 14:31; Job 29:15-16
- v14 — Prov 19:17; Acts 24:15; John 5:29; Matt 6:4; Matt 25:34-40
- v15 — Rev 19:9; Luke 13:29; Luke 22:30
- v23 — Matt 22:9-10; Col 1:28; 2 Cor 5:11; Acts 13:47-48; 2 Cor 5:20
- v24 — Matt 21:43; Acts 13:46; Matt 22:8; John 8:24; John 3:36
- v26 — Matt 10:37; John 12:25; Phil 3:8; Acts 20:24; Ps 73:25-26
- v27 — Matt 10:38; Luke 9:23-25; Matt 16:24-26; Mark 10:21; Mark 8:34-37
- v28 — Prov 24:27; Matt 10:22; Josh 24:19-24; Luke 14:33; Matt 8:20
- v33 — Phil 3:7-8; 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 5:28; Luke 14:26; Luke 18:28-30
- v34 — Matt 5:13; Col 4:6; Mark 9:49-50

Chapter 15

Jesus tells three parables about what was lost and found: the parable of the lost sheep, the parable of the lost coin, and the parable of the prodigal son. In each parable there is great joy in heaven over one sinner who repents.

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| 1 | <i>Then drew near unto him all the publicans and sinners for to hear him.</i> | All the tax collectors and sinners were coming near to hear Him. |
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| 2 | <i>And the Pharisees and scribes murmured, saying, This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them.</i> | The Pharisees and scribes grumbled, saying, "This man welcomes sinners and eats with them." |
| 3 | <i>And he spake this parable unto them, saying,</i> | So He told them this parable: |
| 4 | <i>What man of you, having an hundred sheep, if he lose one of them, doth not leave the ninety and nine in the wilderness, and go after that which is lost, until he find it?</i> | "Which one of you, having a hundred sheep and losing one of them, does not leave the ninety-nine in the open country and go after the lost one until he finds it? |
| 5 | <i>And when he hath found it, he layeth it on his shoulders, rejoicing.</i> | When he finds it, he joyfully lifts it onto his shoulders. |
| 6 | <i>And when he cometh home, he calleth together his friends and neighbours, saying unto them, Rejoice with me; for I have found my sheep which was lost.</i> | When he arrives home, he calls his friends and neighbors together and says, 'Rejoice with me! I have found my lost sheep.' |
| 7 | <i>I say unto you, that likewise joy shall be in heaven over one sinner that repenteth, more than over ninety and nine just persons, which need no repentance.</i> | I tell you, there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous people who need no repentance. |
| 8 | <i>Either what woman having ten pieces of silver, if she lose one piece, doth not light a candle, and sweep the house, and seek diligently till she find it?</i> | Or what woman, having ten silver coins and losing one, does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it? |
| 9 | <i>And when she hath found it, she calleth her friends and her neighbours together, saying, Rejoice with me; for I have found the piece which I had lost.</i> | When she finds it, she calls her friends and neighbors together and says, 'Rejoice with me! I have found the coin I had lost.' |
| 10 | <i>Likewise, I say unto you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.</i> | In the same way, I tell you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents." |

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| <p>11 <i>And he said, A certain man had two sons:</i></p> | <p>He also said, "A man had two sons.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And the younger of them said to his father, Father, give me the portion of goods that falleth to me. And he divided unto them his living.</i></p> | <p>The younger one said to his father, 'Father, give me my share of the estate.' So the father divided his property between them.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And not many days after the younger son gathered all together, and took his journey into a far country, and there wasted his substance with riotous living.</i></p> | <p>Not long after, the younger son gathered everything together and traveled to a distant country. There he squandered his wealth with wild living.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And when he had spent all, there arose a mighty famine in that land; and he began to be in want.</i></p> | <p>When he had spent everything, a severe famine struck that whole country, and he began to be in need.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And he went and joined himself to a citizen of that country; and he sent him into his fields to feed swine.</i></p> | <p>He went and hired himself out to a citizen of that country, who sent him into his fields to feed pigs.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And he would fain have filled his belly with the husks that the swine did eat: and no man gave unto him.</i></p> | <p>He longed to fill his stomach with the pods that the pigs were eating, but no one gave him anything.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And when he came to himself, he said, How many hired servants of my father's have bread enough and to spare, and I perish with hunger!</i></p> | <p>When he came to his senses, he said, 'How many of my father's hired servants have more than enough food, and here I am starving to death!</p> |
| <p>18 <i>I will arise and go to my father, and will say unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and before thee,</i></p> | <p>I will get up and go to my father and say to him, "Father, I have sinned against heaven and against you.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And am no more worthy to be called thy son: make me as one of thy hired servants.</i></p> | <p>I am no longer worthy to be called your son. Make me like one of your hired servants." '</p> |

- 20 *And he arose, and came to his father. But when he was yet a great way off, his father saw him, and had compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him.* So he got up and went to his father. While he was still a long way off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion. He ran to his son, threw his arms around him, and kissed him.
- 21 *And the son said unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son.* The son said to him, 'Father, I have sinned against heaven and in your sight. I am no longer worthy to be called your son.'
- 22 *But the father said to his servants, Bring forth the best robe, and put it on him; and put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet:* But the father said to his servants, 'Bring out the best robe and put it on him. Put a ring on his finger and sandals on his feet.
- 23 *And bring hither the fatted calf, and kill it; and let us eat, and be merry:* Bring the fattened calf and kill it. Let us eat and celebrate!
- 24 *For this my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found. And they began to be merry.* For this son of mine was dead and is alive again. He was lost and is found.' And they began to celebrate.
- 25 *Now his elder son was in the field: and as he came and drew nigh to the house, he heard musick and dancing.* Now the older son was in the field. As he came near the house, he heard music and dancing.
- 26 *And he called one of the servants, and asked what these things meant.* He called one of the servants and asked what was happening.
- 27 *And he said unto him, Thy brother is come; and thy father hath killed the fatted calf, because he hath received him safe and sound.* The servant told him, 'Your brother has come, and your father has killed the fattened calf, because he received him back safe and well.'
- 28 *And he was angry, and would not go in: therefore came his father out, and intreated him.* The older son became angry and refused to go in. So his father came out and pleaded with him.

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| <p>29 <i>And he answering said to his father, Lo, these many years do I serve thee, neither transgressed I at any time thy commandment: and yet thou never gavest me a kid, that I might make merry with my friends:</i></p> | <p>The son answered his father, 'Look, all these years I have worked for you and never disobeyed your commands. Yet you never gave me even a young goat so I could celebrate with my friends.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>But as soon as this thy son was come, which hath devoured thy living with harlots, thou hast killed for him the fatted calf.</i></p> | <p>But when this son of yours, who has wasted your property with prostitutes, came back — you killed the fattened calf for him!</p> |
| <p>31 <i>And he said unto him, Son, thou art ever with me, and all that I have is thine.</i></p> | <p>The father said to him, 'Son, you have always been with me, and everything I have is yours.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>It was meet that we should make merry, and be glad: for this thy brother was dead, and is alive again; and was lost, and is found.</i></p> | <p>But it was right that we should celebrate and be glad. For this brother of yours was dead and is alive again. He was lost and is found.' "</p> |

Words in this chapter:

fain — Gladly; willingly — 'he would fain have filled his belly' means he was desperate to eat.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Tim 1:15; Matt 9:10-13; Luke 5:29-32; Matt 21:28-31; Ezek 18:27
- v2 — Matt 9:11; Luke 19:7; Luke 7:39; Luke 5:30; Acts 11:3
- v4 — Ezek 34:16; Ezek 34:11-12; Matt 18:12-14; Luke 19:10; 1 Pet 2:25
- v7 — Luke 15:10; Luke 5:32; Luke 15:32; Matt 18:13; Prov 30:12
- v8 — Ezek 34:12; Luke 19:10; John 10:16; John 11:52
- v10 — Luke 15:7; Ezek 33:11; 2 Cor 7:10; Ezek 18:23; Luke 13:5
- v17 — Ezek 18:28; Eph 2:4-5; Eph 5:14; Luke 15:18-19; Acts 16:29-30
- v18 — Lam 3:40; 1 John 1:8-10; Luke 15:21; Ps 51:3-5; Jer 50:4-5
- v20 — Ps 103:10-13; Ps 86:5; Ps 86:15; Eph 2:13; Deut 30:2-4
- v22 — Gen 41:42; Esth 8:2; Rev 6:11; Esth 3:10; Zech 3:3-5
- v24 — Eph 2:5; Ezek 34:16; Luke 19:10; Col 2:13; Luke 15:4
- v32 — Eph 2:1-10; Luke 15:24; Isa 35:10; Ps 51:8; Rom 3:4

Chapter 16

Jesus tells the parable of the unjust steward and teaches about faithfulness in that which is least and the impossibility of serving both God and mammon. He tells of the rich man and Lazarus, where the rich man dies and is tormented in hell while Lazarus rests in Abraham's bosom.

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| <p>1 <i>And he said also unto his disciples, There was a certain rich man, which had a steward; and the same was accused unto him that he had wasted his goods.</i></p> | <p>Jesus also said to His disciples: "There was a rich man whose manager was accused of wasting His possessions.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he called him, and said unto him, How is it that I hear this of thee? give an account of thy stewardship; for thou mayest be no longer steward.</i></p> | <p>He called the manager in and said, 'What is this I hear about You? Give an account of Your management, because You can no longer be manager.'</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Then the steward said within himself, What shall I do? for my lord taketh away from me the stewardship: I cannot dig; to beg I am ashamed.</i></p> | <p>The manager said to himself, 'What will I do? My master is taking away my job. I am not strong enough to dig, and I am ashamed to beg.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>I am resolved what to do, that, when I am put out of the stewardship, they may receive me into their houses.</i></p> | <p>I know what I will do, so that when I am removed from this position, people will welcome me into their homes.'</p> |
| <p>5 <i>So he called every one of his lord's debtors unto him, and said unto the first, How much owest thou unto my lord?</i></p> | <p>He called in each of his master's debtors. He asked the first, 'How much do you owe my master?'</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And he said, An hundred measures of oil. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and sit down quickly, and write fifty.</i></p> | <p>'Eight hundred gallons of olive oil,' he replied. The manager said, 'Take your bill, sit down quickly, and write four hundred.'</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Then said he to another, And how much owest thou? And he said, An hundred measures of wheat. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and write fourscore.</i></p> | <p>Then he asked another, 'And how much do you owe?' 'A thousand bushels of wheat,' he replied. He said, 'Take your bill and write eight hundred.'</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>And the lord commended the unjust steward, because he had done wisely: for the children of this world are in their generation wiser than the children of light.</i></p> | <p>The master commended the dishonest manager for acting shrewdly. For the people of this world are shrewder in dealing with their own kind than the people of the light.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And I say unto you, Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness; that, when ye fail, they may receive you into everlasting habitations.</i></p> | <p>I tell you, use worldly wealth to make friends for yourselves, so that when it fails, they will welcome you into eternal dwellings.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much: and he that is unjust in the least is unjust also in much.</i></p> | <p>Whoever is faithful in a very little is also faithful in much. Whoever is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>If therefore ye have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches?</i></p> | <p>If then you have not been faithful in the use of worldly wealth, who will trust you with true riches?</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And if ye have not been faithful in that which is another man's, who shall give you that which is your own?</i></p> | <p>And if you have not been faithful with what belongs to someone else, who will give you what is your own?</p> |
| <p>13 <i>No servant can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon.</i></p> | <p>No servant can serve two masters. Either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve both God and money."</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And the Pharisees also, who were covetous, heard all these things: and they derided him.</i></p> | <p>The Pharisees, who loved money, heard all this and were sneering at Jesus.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And he said unto them, Ye are they which justify yourselves before men; but God knoweth your hearts: for that which is highly esteemed among men is abomination in the sight of God.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "You are the ones who justify yourselves in the sight of men. But God knows Your hearts. What is highly valued among men is an abomination in God's sight.</p> |

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| <p>16 <i>The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and every man presseth into it.</i></p> | <p>The Law and the Prophets were proclaimed until John. Since that time, the good news of the kingdom of God is being preached, and everyone is pressing into it.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than one tittle of the law to fail.</i></p> | <p>It is easier for heaven and earth to disappear than for the smallest part of the Law to fall away.</p> |
| <p>18 <i>Whosoever putteth away his wife, and marrieth another, committeth adultery: and whosoever marrieth her that is put away from her husband committeth adultery.</i></p> | <p>Everyone who divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery. And everyone who marries a woman divorced from her husband commits adultery.</p> |
| <p>19 <i>There was a certain rich man, which was clothed in purple and fine linen, and fared sumptuously every day:</i></p> | <p>There was a rich man who dressed in purple and fine linen and lived in luxury every day.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And there was a certain beggar named Lazarus, which was laid at his gate, full of sores,</i></p> | <p>At his gate lay a beggar named Lazarus, covered with sores.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lazarus** (LAZ-uh-russ) — "God is my help" — A poor, sick beggar in Jesus' parable about wealth and the afterlife.

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| <p>21 <i>And desiring to be fed with the crumbs which fell from the rich man's table: moreover the dogs came and licked his sores.</i></p> | <p>He longed to be fed with the crumbs that fell from the rich man's table. Even the dogs came and licked his sores.</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom: the rich man also died, and was buried;</i></p> | <p>The beggar died and was carried by the angels to Abraham's side. The rich man also died and was buried.</p> |
| <p>23 <i>And in hell he lift up his eyes, being in torments, and seeth Abraham afar off, and Lazarus in his bosom.</i></p> | <p>In hell, the rich man was in torment. He looked up and saw Abraham far away, with Lazarus at his side.</p> |

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| <p>24 <i>And he cried and said, Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water, and cool my tongue; for I am tormented in this flame.</i></p> | <p>He called out, 'Father Abraham, have mercy on me! Send Lazarus to dip the tip of his finger in water and cool my tongue, for I am in agony in this fire.'</p> |
| <p>25 <i>But Abraham said, Son, remember that thou in thy lifetime receivedst thy good things, and likewise Lazarus evil things: but now he is comforted, and thou art tormented.</i></p> | <p>But Abraham replied, 'Son, remember that in your lifetime you received good things, while Lazarus received evil things. But now he is comforted here, and you are in agony.'</p> |
| <p>26 <i>And beside all this, between us and you there is a great gulf fixed: so that they which would pass from hence to you cannot; neither can they pass to us, that would come from thence.</i></p> | <p>Besides all this, a great chasm has been fixed between us and you. Those who want to pass from here to you cannot, nor can anyone cross over from there to us.'</p> |
| <p>27 <i>Then he said, I pray thee therefore, father, that thou wouldest send him to my father's house:</i></p> | <p>Then he said, 'Then I beg you, father, send Lazarus to my father's house,</p> |
| <p>28 <i>For I have five brethren; that he may testify unto them, lest they also come into this place of torment.</i></p> | <p>for I have five brothers. Let him warn them, so that they will not also come to this place of torment.'</p> |
| <p>29 <i>Abraham saith unto him, They have Moses and the prophets; let them hear them.</i></p> | <p>Abraham replied, 'They have Moses and the Prophets. Let them listen to them.'</p> |
| <p>30 <i>And he said, Nay, father Abraham: but if one went unto them from the dead, they will repent.</i></p> | <p>'No, father Abraham,' he said, 'but if someone from the dead goes to them, they will repent.'</p> |
| <p>31 <i>And he said unto him, If they hear not Moses and the prophets, neither will they be persuaded, though one rose from the dead.</i></p> | <p>Abraham said to him, 'If they do not listen to Moses and the Prophets, they will not be persuaded even if someone rises from the dead.' "</p> |

Words in this chapter:

mammon (MAM-un) — An Aramaic word for wealth or riches — Jesus used it as a personified rival to God, warning that no one can serve both God and Mammon.

Lazarus (LAZ-ah-rus) — The brother of Mary and Martha whom Jesus raised from the dead after four days in the tomb — his name is a form of Eleazar, meaning 'God has helped.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 4:10; Matt 25:14-30; Luke 12:42; Jas 4:3; 1 Cor 4:1-2
- v9 — Matt 19:21; 1 Tim 6:17-19; Matt 6:24; Dan 4:27; Prov 19:17
- v10 — Luke 16:11-12; Matt 25:21; Luke 19:17; Matt 25:23; Heb 3:2
- v13 — 1 John 2:15-16; Matt 6:24; Jas 4:4; Rom 8:5-8; Luke 14:26
- v15 — Prov 21:2; 1 Sam 16:7; 1 Cor 4:5; Jer 17:10; Prov 16:5
- v16 — Matt 11:9-14; Matt 21:32; Acts 3:24-25; Matt 3:2; Luke 7:26-29
- v17 — Matt 5:18; Luke 21:33; 1 Pet 1:25; Isa 40:8; Rom 3:31
- v18 — Matt 19:9; Mark 10:11-12; Matt 5:31-32; 1 Cor 7:10-12; 1 Cor 7:4
- v22 — 1 Pet 2:24; Ps 49:16-19; Jas 1:11; Rev 14:13; Prov 14:32
- v23 — 2 Pet 2:4; Matt 23:33; Matt 18:9; Luke 16:28
- v24 — John 4:10; Rev 22:1; John 4:14; Rev 7:16-17; Matt 25:41
- v25 — Luke 6:24; 1 John 2:15; Ps 17:14; Mark 9:45; Rom 8:7

Chapter 17

Jesus teaches His disciples about offenses, forgiveness, and faith, telling them that faith the size of a mustard seed can uproot a tree. He cleanses ten lepers, and only one — a Samaritan — returns to give thanks. He teaches about the coming of the kingdom of God and the day of the Son of man.

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| <p>1 <i>Then said he unto the disciples, It is impossible but that offences will come: but woe unto him, through whom they come!</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to His disciples, "It is inevitable that stumbling blocks will come — but woe to the one through whom they come!</p> |
| <p>2 <i>It were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he cast into the sea, than that he should offend one of these little ones.</i></p> | <p>It would be better for Him to have a millstone hung around His neck and be thrown into the sea than to cause one of these little ones to stumble.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Take heed to yourselves: If thy brother trespass against thee, rebuke him; and if he repent, forgive him.</i></p> | <p>Watch yourselves. If Your brother sins against You, rebuke Him. If He repents, forgive Him.</p> |

- 4 *And if he trespass against thee seven times in a day, and seven times in a day turn again to thee, saying, I repent; thou shalt forgive him.* Even if He sins against You seven times in a day and seven times comes back to You saying, 'I repent,' you must forgive Him."
- 5 *And the apostles said unto the Lord, Increase our faith.* The apostles said to the Lord, "Increase our faith!"
- 6 *And the Lord said, If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye might say unto this sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root, and be thou planted in the sea; and it should obey you.* The Lord replied, "If You had faith as small as a grain of mustard seed, You could say to this mulberry tree, 'Be uprooted and planted in the sea,' and it would obey You.
- 7 *But which of you, having a servant plowing or feeding cattle, will say unto him by and by, when he is come from the field, Go and sit down to meat?* Which of You, having a servant who is plowing or tending sheep, will say to Him when He comes in from the field, 'Come right in and sit down to eat'?
- 8 *And will not rather say unto him, Make ready wherewith I may sup, and gird thyself, and serve me, till I have eaten and drunken; and afterward thou shalt eat and drink?* Will He not say instead, 'Prepare my supper, get dressed and serve me while I eat and drink — and after that You may eat and drink'?
- 9 *Doth he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded him? I trow not.* Does He thank the servant because he did what was commanded? I think not.
- 10 *So likewise ye, when ye shall have done all those things which are commanded you, say, We are unprofitable servants: we have done that which was our duty to do.* So You also, when You have done everything commanded of You, say, 'We are unworthy servants. We have only done our duty.' "
- 11 *And it came to pass, as he went to Jerusalem, that he passed through the midst of Samaria and Galilee.* As Jesus made His way to Jerusalem, He passed through the midst of Samaria and Galilee.

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| <p>12 <i>And as he entered into a certain village, there met him ten men that were lepers, which stood afar off:</i></p> | <p>As He entered a village, ten men who had leprosy met Him. They stood at a distance</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And they lifted up their voices, and said, Jesus, Master, have mercy on us.</i></p> | <p>and cried out in a loud voice, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!"</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And when he saw them, he said unto them, Go shew yourselves unto the priests. And it came to pass, that, as they went, they were cleansed.</i></p> | <p>When He saw them, He said, "Go, show yourselves to the priests." And as they went, they were cleansed.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And one of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, and with a loud voice glorified God,</i></p> | <p>One of them, when He saw that He was healed, came back, praising God in a loud voice.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And fell down on his face at his feet, giving him thanks: and he was a Samaritan.</i></p> | <p>He fell on His face at Jesus' feet and thanked Him. And He was a Samaritan.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And Jesus answering said, Were there not ten cleansed? but where are the nine?</i></p> | <p>Jesus asked, "Were not ten cleansed? Where are the other nine?"</p> |
| <p>18 <i>There are not found that returned to give glory to God, save this stranger.</i></p> | <p>Has no one returned to give glory to God except this foreigner?"</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And he said unto him, Arise, go thy way: thy faith hath made thee whole.</i></p> | <p>Then He said to Him, "Rise and go. Your faith has made You well."</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And when he was demanded of the Pharisees, when the kingdom of God should come, he answered them and said, The kingdom of God cometh not with observation:</i></p> | <p>When the Pharisees asked Jesus when the kingdom of God would come, He answered, "The kingdom of God does not come with signs to be observed.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>Neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the kingdom of God is within you.</i></p> | <p>People will not say, 'Look, here it is!' or 'There it is!' For the kingdom of God is within You."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>And he said unto the disciples, The days will come, when ye shall desire to see one of the days of the Son of man, and ye shall not see it.</i></p> | <p>Then He said to the disciples, "The time will come when You will long to see one of the days of the Son of Man, but You will not see it.</p> |

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| <p>23 <i>And they shall say to you, See here; or, see there: go not after them, nor follow them.</i></p> | <p>People will say, 'Look there!' or 'Look here!' Do not go after them or follow them.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>For as the lightning, that lighteneth out of the one part under heaven, shineth unto the other part under heaven; so shall also the Son of man be in his day.</i></p> | <p>For as the lightning flashes and lights up the sky from one end to the other, so will the Son of Man be in His day.</p> |
| <p>25 <i>But first must he suffer many things, and be rejected of this generation.</i></p> | <p>But first He must suffer many things and be rejected by this generation.</p> |
| <p>26 <i>And as it was in the days of Noe, so shall it be also in the days of the Son of man.</i></p> | <p>Just as it was in the days of Noah, so will it be in the days of the Son of Man.</p> |
| <p>27 <i>They did eat, they drank, they married wives, they were given in marriage, until the day that Noe entered into the ark, and the flood came, and destroyed them all.</i></p> | <p>People were eating and drinking, marrying and being given in marriage, right up to the day Noah entered the ark. Then the flood came and destroyed them all.</p> |
| <p>28 <i>Likewise also as it was in the days of Lot; they did eat, they drank, they bought, they sold, they planted, they builded;</i></p> | <p>It was the same in the days of Lot. People were eating and drinking, buying and selling, planting and building.</p> |
| <p>29 <i>But the same day that Lot went out of Sodom it rained fire and brimstone from heaven, and destroyed them all.</i></p> | <p>But the day Lot left Sodom, fire and sulfur rained down from heaven and destroyed them all.</p> |
| <p>30 <i>Even thus shall it be in the day when the Son of man is revealed.</i></p> | <p>It will be just like that on the day the Son of Man is revealed.</p> |
| <p>31 <i>In that day, he which shall be upon the housetop, and his stuff in the house, let him not come down to take it away: and he that is in the field, let him likewise not return back.</i></p> | <p>On that day, no one on the housetop, with belongings in the house, should come down to take them. Likewise, no one in the field should turn back.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>Remember Lot's wife.</i></p> | <p>Remember Lot's wife!</p> |

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| 33 | <i>Whosoever shall seek to save his life shall lose it; and whosoever shall lose his life shall preserve it.</i> | Whoever seeks to save his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life will preserve it. |
| 34 | <i>I tell you, in that night there shall be two men in one bed; the one shall be taken, and the other shall be left.</i> | I tell you, on that night two people will be in one bed. One will be taken and the other left. |
| 35 | <i>Two women shall be grinding together; the one shall be taken, and the other left.</i> | Two women will be grinding grain together. One will be taken and the other left. |
| 36 | <i>Two men shall be in the field; the one shall be taken, and the other left.</i> | Two men will be in the field. One will be taken and the other left. |
| 37 | <i>And they answered and said unto him, Where, Lord? And he said unto them, Wheresoever the body is, thither will the eagles be gathered together.</i> | They asked Him, "Where, Lord?" He said to them, "Where the body is, there the eagles will be gathered together." |

Words in this chapter:

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Matt 18:7; Rom 14:13; 1 Cor 11:19; Rom 16:17; 1 Cor 8:13
- v2** — Mark 9:42; Matt 18:14; Matt 18:3-6; Matt 18:10; 1 Cor 8:11-12
- v3** — Lev 19:17; Matt 18:21; Matt 18:15-17; Prov 9:8; Jas 5:19
- v4** — Col 3:12-13; Matt 18:21-22; Rom 12:20; Matt 6:14-15; Matt 5:44
- v5** — Mark 9:24; Heb 12:2; Phil 4:13; 2 Cor 12:8-10; 2 Thess 1:3
- v6** — Matt 17:20; Mark 9:23; Matt 21:21; Matt 13:31-32; 1 Cor 13:2
- v10** — 1 Cor 9:16-17; Job 22:2-3; 1 Pet 5:5-6; 1 Cor 15:9-10; Job 35:6-7
- v15** — Ps 30:11-12; Ps 103:1-4; Ps 118:18-19; Luke 17:17-18; John 9:38
- v21** — Matt 12:28; Rom 14:17; Mark 13:21; Col 1:27; Luke 10:9-11
- v32** — Gen 19:26; Heb 10:38-39; 2 Pet 2:18-22; 1 Cor 10:6-12; Gen 19:17
- v33** — Mark 8:35-37; Matt 10:39; John 12:25; Luke 9:24-25; Matt 16:25
- v34** — Matt 24:40-41; 2 Pet 2:9; Mal 3:16-18; 1 Thess 4:16-17

Chapter 18

Jesus tells the parable of the persistent widow and the parable of the Pharisee and the tax collector who went up to the temple to pray. He blesses little children, tells a rich ruler to sell all he has, foretells His death and resurrection, and heals a blind man near Jericho.

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| 1 <i>And he spake a parable unto them to this end, that men ought always to pray, and not to faint;</i> | Jesus told them a parable to show that they should always pray and not give up. |
| 2 <i>Saying, There was in a city a judge, which feared not God, neither regarded man:</i> | He said, "In a certain city there was a judge who neither feared God nor cared about people. |
| 3 <i>And there was a widow in that city; and she came unto him, saying, Avenge me of mine adversary.</i> | In that city there was a widow who kept coming to Him, saying, 'Give me justice against my adversary.' |
| 4 <i>And he would not for a while: but afterward he said within himself, Though I fear not God, nor regard man;</i> | For a while He refused. But finally He said to Himself, 'Though I neither fear God nor care about people, |
| 5 <i>Yet because this widow troubleth me, I will avenge her, lest by her continual coming she weary me.</i> | yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will give her justice — so that she will not wear me out by her constant coming.' " |
| 6 <i>And the Lord said, Hear what the unjust judge saith.</i> | The Lord said, "Hear what the unrighteous judge says. |
| 7 <i>And shall not God avenge his own elect, which cry day and night unto him, though he bear long with them?</i> | Will not God bring about justice for His chosen ones, who cry out to Him day and night? Will He keep putting them off? |
| 8 <i>I tell you that he will avenge them speedily. Nevertheless when the Son of man cometh, shall he find faith on the earth?</i> | I tell You, He will see that they get justice quickly. Yet when the Son of Man comes, will He find faith on the earth?" |

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| <p>9 <i>And he spake this parable unto certain which trusted in themselves that they were righteous, and despised others:</i></p> <p>10 <i>Two men went up into the temple to pray; the one a Pharisee, and the other a publican.</i></p> <p>11 <i>The Pharisee stood and prayed thus with himself, God, I thank thee, that I am not as other men are, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even as this publican.</i></p> <p>12 <i>I fast twice in the week, I give tithes of all that I possess.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the publican, standing afar off, would not lift up so much as his eyes unto heaven, but smote upon his breast, saying, God be merciful to me a sinner.</i></p> <p>14 <i>I tell you, this man went down to his house justified rather than the other: for every one that exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.</i></p> | <p>He also told this parable to some who were confident in their own righteousness and looked down on everyone else:</p> <p>"Two men went up to the temple to pray — one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector.</p> <p>The Pharisee stood and prayed about himself: 'God, I thank You that I am not like other men — robbers, evildoers, adulterers — or even like this tax collector.</p> <p>I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.'</p> <p>But the tax collector stood far away. He would not even lift His eyes toward heaven, but beat His chest and said, 'God, have mercy on me, a sinner.'</p> <p>I tell you, this man went home justified before God — not the other. For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and everyone who humbles himself will be exalted."</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Justified** (JUS-tih-fyd) — Declared not guilty by God; legally counted as righteous. To be justified means God pronounces you righteous — not because you earned it, but because of Christ.

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| <p>15 <i>And they brought unto him also infants, that he would touch them: but when his disciples saw it, they rebuked them.</i></p> | <p>People were bringing babies to Jesus for Him to touch. When the disciples saw this, they rebuked them.</p> |
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| <p>16 <i>But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Suffer little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>But Jesus called the children to Him and said, "Let the little children come to Me and do not stop them. For the kingdom of God belongs to such as these.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child shall in no wise enter therein.</i></p> | <p>Truly I say to You, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God like a little child will never enter it."</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And a certain ruler asked him, saying, Good Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?</i></p> | <p>A certain ruler asked Him, "Good Master, what must I do to inherit eternal life?"</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And Jesus said unto him, Why callest thou me good? none is good, save one, that is, God.</i></p> | <p>Jesus replied, "Why do You call Me good? No one is good except God alone.</p> |
| <p>20 <i>Thou knowest the commandments, Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother.</i></p> | <p>You know the commandments: 'Do not commit adultery. Do not murder. Do not steal. Do not give false testimony. Honor Your father and mother.' "</p> |
| <p>21 <i>And he said, All these have I kept from my youth up.</i></p> | <p>The ruler said, "All these I have kept since I was a boy."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>Now when Jesus heard these things, he said unto him, Yet lackest thou one thing: sell all that thou hast, and distribute unto the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come, follow me.</i></p> | <p>When Jesus heard this, He said to Him, "You still lack one thing. Sell everything You have and give to the poor, and You will have treasure in heaven. Then come, follow Me."</p> |
| <p>23 <i>And when he heard this, he was very sorrowful: for he was very rich.</i></p> | <p>When the ruler heard this, He became very sorrowful, for He was very wealthy.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>And when Jesus saw that he was very sorrowful, he said, How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God!</i></p> | <p>Jesus looked at Him and said, "How hard it is for the wealthy to enter the kingdom of God!</p> |

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| <p>25 <i>For it is easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God."</p> |
| <p>26 <i>And they that heard it said, Who then can be saved?</i></p> | <p>Those who heard this asked, "Who then can be saved?"</p> |
| <p>27 <i>And he said, The things which are impossible with men are possible with God.</i></p> | <p>Jesus replied, "What is impossible with men is possible with God."</p> |
| <p>28 <i>Then Peter said, Lo, we have left all, and followed thee.</i></p> | <p>Peter said, "We have left everything we had to follow You!"</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And he said unto them, Verily I say unto you, There is no man that hath left house, or parents, or brethren, or wife, or children, for the kingdom of God's sake,</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to them, "Truly I say to You, there is no one who has left house or parents or brothers or wife or children for the sake of the kingdom of God</p> |
| <p>30 <i>Who shall not receive manifold more in this present time, and in the world to come life everlasting.</i></p> | <p>who will not receive many times as much in this age — and in the age to come, eternal life."</p> |
| <p>31 <i>Then he took unto him the twelve, and said unto them, Behold, we go up to Jerusalem, and all things that are written by the prophets concerning the Son of man shall be accomplished.</i></p> | <p>Jesus took the Twelve aside and said to them, "We are going up to Jerusalem, and everything written by the prophets about the Son of Man will be fulfilled.</p> |
| <p>32 <i>For he shall be delivered unto the Gentiles, and shall be mocked, and spitefully entreated, and spitted on:</i></p> | <p>He will be handed over to the Gentiles. They will mock Him, insult Him, and spit on Him.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And they shall scourge him, and put him to death: and the third day he shall rise again.</i></p> | <p>They will flog Him and kill Him. On the third day He will rise again."</p> |
| <p>34 <i>And they understood none of these things: and this saying was hid from them, neither knew they the things which were spoken.</i></p> | <p>The disciples understood none of this. The meaning was hidden from them, and they did not know what He was talking about.</p> |

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| <p>35 <i>And it came to pass, that as he was come nigh unto Jericho, a certain blind man sat by the way side begging:</i></p> <p>36 <i>And hearing the multitude pass by, he asked what it meant.</i></p> <p>37 <i>And they told him, that Jesus of Nazareth passeth by.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And he cried, saying, Jesus, thou Son of David, have mercy on me.</i></p> <p>39 <i>And they which went before rebuked him, that he should hold his peace: but he cried so much the more, Thou Son of David, have mercy on me.</i></p> <p>40 <i>And Jesus stood, and commanded him to be brought unto him: and when he was come near, he asked him,</i></p> <p>41 <i>Saying, What wilt thou that I shall do unto thee? And he said, Lord, that I may receive my sight.</i></p> <p>42 <i>And Jesus said unto him, Receive thy sight: thy faith hath saved thee.</i></p> <p>43 <i>And immediately he received his sight, and followed him, glorifying God: and all the people, when they saw it, gave praise unto God.</i></p> | <p>As Jesus approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting beside the road, begging.</p> <p>When He heard the crowd going by, He asked what was happening.</p> <p>They told Him, "Jesus of Nazareth is passing by."</p> <p>He called out, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!"</p> <p>Those who led the way rebuked him and told him to be quiet. But he shouted all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"</p> <p>Jesus stopped and ordered the man to be brought to him. When he came near, Jesus asked Him,</p> <p>"What do You want Me to do for You?" He said, "Lord, I want to see."</p> <p>Jesus said to Him, "Receive Your sight. Your faith has saved You."</p> <p>Immediately He received His sight and followed Jesus, praising God. When all the people saw it, they also praised God.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

publican — A Jewish tax collector working for Rome — despised by fellow Jews as a traitor and swindler; also called 'tax collectors' in modern translations.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Jericho (*JEHR-ih-ko*) — The first city Israel conquered in Canaan — its walls fell when the priests blew their trumpets on the seventh day after seven days of marching; its name may mean 'city of the moon.'

Nazareth (NAZ-ah-reth) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Col 4:2; Rom 12:12; 1 Thess 5:17; Phil 4:6; Eph 6:18
- v5 — Luke 11:8; Luke 18:39; Judg 16:16; Mark 10:47-48; Matt 15:23
- v7 — Heb 10:35-37; 2 Pet 3:9; 1 Tim 5:5; Luke 11:13; Jer 20:11-13
- v8 — Heb 10:23-26; 2 Pet 3:8-9; Matt 24:9-13; Ps 46:5; Luke 17:26-30
- v9 — Luke 16:15; Prov 30:12; Isa 65:5; Rom 10:3; Rom 14:10
- v11 — Matt 6:5; Rev 3:17; Isa 65:5; Jer 2:35; Mark 11:25
- v13 — Ezra 9:6; 1 John 1:8-10; 1 Tim 1:15; Ps 41:4; Heb 8:12
- v14 — Luke 14:11; Luke 16:15; Jas 4:10; Matt 23:12; Prov 29:23
- v18 — Mark 10:17-31; Acts 16:30; Matt 19:16-30; Acts 2:37; Ezek 33:31
- v27 — Jer 32:17; Matt 19:26; Luke 1:37; Job 42:2; Gen 18:14
- v29 — Mark 10:29-31; Luke 14:26-28; Matt 10:37-39; Matt 19:28-30; Deut 33:9
- v31 — Matt 20:17-19; Isa 53:1-12; Ps 22:1-31; Mark 10:32-34; Matt 16:21

Chapter 19

Zacchaeus the tax collector climbs a sycamore tree to see Jesus, and Jesus declares salvation has come to his house. Jesus tells the parable of the ten pounds and enters Jerusalem riding on a colt as the crowds praise God. He weeps over the city and drives the merchants out of the temple.

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| 1 | <i>And Jesus entered and passed through Jericho.</i> | Jesus entered Jericho and was passing through. |
| 2 | <i>And, behold, there was a man named Zacchaeus, which was the chief among the publicans, and he was rich.</i> | There was a man there named Zacchaeus. He was the chief tax collector, and He was wealthy. |
| 3 | <i>And he sought to see Jesus who he was; and could not for the press, because he was little of stature.</i> | He wanted to see who Jesus was, but He could not, because the crowd was too large. He was short in stature. |
| 4 | <i>And he ran before, and climbed up into a sycomore tree to see him: for he was to pass that way.</i> | So He ran ahead and climbed a sycamore tree to see Jesus, because He was about to pass that way. |

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| <p>5 <i>And when Jesus came to the place, he looked up, and saw him, and said unto him, Zacchaeus, make haste, and come down; for to day I must abide at thy house.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And he made haste, and came down, and received him joyfully.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And when they saw it, they all murmured, saying, That he was gone to be guest with a man that is a sinner.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And Jesus said unto him, This day is salvation come to this house, forsomuch as he also is a son of Abraham.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And as they heard these things, he added and spake a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem, and because they thought that the kingdom of God should immediately appear.</i></p> <p>12 <i>He said therefore, A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom, and to return.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And he called his ten servants, and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy till I come.</i></p> | <p>When Jesus came to the place, He looked up and said to Him, "Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for I must stay at Your house today."</p> <p>He hurried and came down, and received Him joyfully.</p> <p>All the people saw this and began to grumble, saying, "He has gone to be a guest with a man who is a sinner."</p> <p>Zacchaeus stood and said to the Lord, "Lord, I give half of my goods to the poor. And if I have taken anything from anyone by false accusation, I will restore it fourfold."</p> <p>Jesus said to Him, "Today salvation has come to this house, since He also is a son of Abraham."</p> <p>For the Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost.</p> <p>As they were listening to these things, He went on to tell a parable. He was near Jerusalem, and they thought the kingdom of God was going to appear at any moment.</p> <p>He said, "A certain nobleman went to a distant country to receive a kingdom for Himself and then return."</p> <p>He called His ten servants and gave them ten pounds, saying to them, 'Do business with this until I come back.'</p> |
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- 14 *But his citizens hated him, and sent a message after him, saying, We will not have this man to reign over us.* But his citizens hated him and sent a delegation after him, saying, 'We do not want this man to reign over us.'
- 15 *And it came to pass, that when he was returned, having received the kingdom, then he commanded these servants to be called unto him, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading.* When he returned, having received the kingdom, he commanded the servants to whom he had given the money to be called before him. He wanted to know how much each one had gained by trading.
- 16 *Then came the first, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds.* The first came and said, 'Lord, your pound has made ten more pounds.'
- 17 *And he said unto him, Well, thou good servant: because thou hast been faithful in a very little, have thou authority over ten cities.* He said to him, 'Well done, good servant! Because you have been faithful in a very small matter, you will have authority over ten cities.'
- 18 *And the second came, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds.* The second came and said, 'Lord, your pound has made five more pounds.'
- 19 *And he said likewise to him, Be thou also over five cities.* He said to him as well, 'You will be over five cities.'
- 20 *And another came, saying, Lord, behold, here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin:* Another came and said, 'Lord, here is your pound. I kept it stored away in a cloth.'
- 21 *For I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up that thou layedst not down, and reapest that thou didst not sow.* 'I was afraid of you, because you are a strict man. You take up what you did not put down, and you reap what you did not sow.'
- 22 *And he saith unto him, Out of thine own mouth will I judge thee, thou wicked servant. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up that I laid not down, and reaping that I did not sow:* He said to him, 'I will judge you by your own words, you wicked servant. You knew that I was a strict man, taking up what I did not put down and reaping what I did not sow.'

- 23 *Wherefore then gavest not thou my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have required mine own with usury?* 'Therefore, why did you not put my money in the bank? Then at my coming I could have collected it with interest.'
- 24 *And he said unto them that stood by, Take from him the pound, and give it to him that hath ten pounds.* He said to those standing nearby, 'Take the pound from him and give it to the one who has ten pounds.'
- 25 *(And they said unto him, Lord, he hath ten pounds.)* They said to him, 'Lord, he already has ten pounds.'
- 26 *For I say unto you, That unto every one which hath shall be given; and from him that hath not, even that he hath shall be taken away from him.* 'I tell you that to everyone who has, more will be given. But from the one who has nothing, even what he has will be taken away.'
- 27 *But those mine enemies, which would not that I should reign over them, bring hither, and slay them before me.* 'But those enemies of mine who did not want me to reign over them — bring them here and kill them in my presence.'
- 28 *And when he had thus spoken, he went before, ascending up to Jerusalem.* After Jesus said these things, He went on ahead, going up toward Jerusalem.
- 29 *And it came to pass, when he was come nigh to Bethphage and Bethany, at the mount called the mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples,* When He drew near to Bethphage and Bethany, at the mount called the Mount of Olives, He sent two of His disciples ahead.
- 30 *Saying, Go ye into the village over against you; in the which at your entering ye shall find a colt tied, whereon yet never man sat: loose him, and bring him hither.* He said, "Go into the village ahead of You. As You enter, You will find a colt tied there, on which no one has ever sat. Untie it and bring it here."
- 31 *And if any man ask you, Why do ye loose him? thus shall ye say unto him, Because the Lord hath need of him.* "If anyone asks you, 'Why are you untying it?' say this: 'The Lord has need of it.'"
- 32 *And they that were sent went their way, and found even as he had said unto them.* Those who were sent went and found it just as He had told them.

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| <p>33 <i>And as they were loosing the colt, the owners thereof said unto them, Why loose ye the colt?</i></p> | <p>As they were untying the colt, its owners said to them, "Why are You untying the colt?"</p> |
| <p>34 <i>And they said, The Lord hath need of him.</i></p> | <p>They said, "The Lord has need of it."</p> |
| <p>35 <i>And they brought him to Jesus: and they cast their garments upon the colt, and they set Jesus thereon.</i></p> | <p>They brought it to Jesus, threw their garments on the colt, and set Jesus on it.</p> |
| <p>36 <i>And as he went, they spread their clothes in the way.</i></p> | <p>As He rode along, people spread their clothes on the road.</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And when he was come nigh, even now at the descent of the mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began to rejoice and praise God with a loud voice for all the mighty works that they had seen;</i></p> | <p>When He came near the descent of the Mount of Olives, the whole crowd of disciples began to rejoice and praise God with a loud voice for all the mighty works they had seen.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>Saying, Blessed be the King that cometh in the name of the Lord: peace in heaven, and glory in the highest.</i></p> | <p>They said, "Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord! Peace in heaven and glory in the highest!"</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And some of the Pharisees from among the multitude said unto him, Master, rebuke thy disciples.</i></p> | <p>Some of the Pharisees in the crowd said to Him, "Master, rebuke Your disciples."</p> |
| <p>40 <i>And he answered and said unto them, I tell you that, if these should hold their peace, the stones would immediately cry out.</i></p> | <p>He answered, "I tell you, if these were silent, the very stones would cry out."</p> |
| <p>41 <i>And when he was come near, he beheld the city, and wept over it,</i></p> | <p>When He drew near and saw the city, He wept over it.</p> |
| <p>42 <i>Saying, If thou hadst known, even thou, at least in this thy day, the things which belong unto thy peace! but now they are hid from thine eyes.</i></p> | <p>He said, "If only you had known, even you, on this day, the things that make for your peace! But now they are hidden from your eyes."</p> |

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| <p>43 <i>For the days shall come upon thee, that thine enemies shall cast a trench about thee, and compass thee round, and keep thee in on every side,</i></p> <p>44 <i>And shall lay thee even with the ground, and thy children within thee; and they shall not leave in thee one stone upon another; because thou knewest not the time of thy visitation.</i></p> <p>45 <i>And he went into the temple, and began to cast out them that sold therein, and them that bought;</i></p> <p>46 <i>Saying unto them, It is written, 'My house is the house of prayer: but ye have made it a den of thieves.</i></p> <p>47 <i>And he taught daily in the temple. But the chief priests and the scribes and the chief of the people sought to destroy him,</i></p> <p>48 <i>And could not find what they might do: for all the people were very attentive to hear him.</i></p> | <p>The days will come upon you when your enemies will build a wall around you and surround you from every side.</p> <p>They will level you to the ground — you and your children within you — and they will not leave one stone on another, because you did not recognize the time of your visitation.</p> <p>He went into the temple and began to drive out those who were selling there.</p> <p>He said to them, "It is written, 'My house is a house of prayer,' but you have made it a den of thieves."</p> <p>He was teaching daily in the temple. The chief priests, the scribes, and the leading men of the people were seeking to destroy him.</p> <p>But they could not find a way to do it, because all the people hung on every word he spoke.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Zacchaeus (*zak-EE-us*) — A short tax collector in Jericho who climbed a tree to see Jesus — Jesus called him down and visited his house, and Zacchaeus repented and repaid those he had cheated.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Rev 3:20; John 14:23; Heb 13:2; John 1:48; Eph 3:17
- v7 — Luke 7:39; Luke 15:2; Luke 7:34; Matt 9:11; Luke 5:30
- v8 — 2 Sam 12:6; Num 5:7; Luke 18:22-23; Lev 6:1-6; Prov 6:31
- v9 — Gal 3:7; Luke 13:16; Rom 4:16; Acts 16:30-32; Gal 3:29
- v10 — Ezek 34:16; Matt 1:21; 1 Tim 1:13-16; Luke 5:31-32; Luke 15:4-7
- v13 — Matt 25:14-15; John 12:26; 1 Cor 12:7-11; 1 Pet 4:9-11; Rom 12:6-8
- v27 — Luke 19:14; Ps 21:8-9; Matt 22:7; Num 16:30-35; Luke 21:22
- v38 — Zech 9:9; Luke 13:35; Ps 118:22-26; Matt 21:9; Mark 11:9-10

v40 — Hab 2:11; Isa 55:12; Matt 3:9; Ps 96:11; Ps 98:7-9

v42 — Deut 32:29; Isa 48:18; Luke 1:77-79; Heb 10:26-29; 2 Cor 6:1-2

v44 — Luke 21:6; Luke 13:34-35; John 3:18-21; 1 Pet 2:12; Lam 1:8

v46 — Isa 56:7; Jer 7:11

Chapter 20

The chief priests and scribes challenge Jesus's authority, and He answers with the parable of the wicked husbandmen. They try to trap Him with questions about paying tribute to Caesar and the resurrection of the dead, but He silences them each time.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, that on one of those days, as he taught the people in the temple, and preached the gospel, the chief priests and the scribes came upon him with the elders,</i></p> | <p>One day as He was teaching the people in the temple and proclaiming the gospel, the chief priests and the scribes came up to Him with the elders.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And spake unto him, saying, Tell us, by what authority doest thou these things? or who is he that gave thee this authority?</i></p> | <p>They said to Him, "Tell us, by what authority are You doing these things? Who gave You this authority?"</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he answered and said unto them, I will also ask you one thing; and answer me:</i></p> | <p>He answered them, "I also will ask You a question. Tell me:"</p> |
| <p>4 <i>The baptism of John, was it from heaven, or of men?</i></p> | <p>"Was the baptism of John from heaven, or from men?"</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say, Why then believed ye him not?</i></p> | <p>They discussed it among themselves, saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' He will say, 'Why did You not believe Him?'"</p> |
| <p>6 <i>But and if we say, Of men; all the people will stone us: for they be persuaded that John was a prophet.</i></p> | <p>"But if we say, 'From men,' all the people will stone us, because they are convinced that John was a prophet."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And they answered, that they could not tell whence it was.</i></p> | <p>So they answered that they did not know where it was from.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And Jesus said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these things.</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to them, "Neither will I tell You by what authority I do these things."</p> |

- 9 *Then began he to speak to the people this parable; A certain man planted a vineyard, and let it forth to husbandmen, and went into a far country for a long time.* Then He began to tell the people this parable: "A man planted a vineyard, rented it out to farmers, and went away to a distant country for a long time."
- 10 *And at the season he sent a servant to the husbandmen, that they should give him of the fruit of the vineyard: but the husbandmen beat him, and sent him away empty.* At harvest time He sent a servant to the farmers to collect some of the fruit. But the farmers beat Him and sent Him away empty-handed.
- 11 *And again he sent another servant: and they beat him also, and entreated him shamefully, and sent him away empty.* He sent another servant, but they beat that one too, treated Him shamefully, and sent Him away empty-handed.
- 12 *And again he sent a third: and they wounded him also, and cast him out.* He sent a third, and they wounded Him too and threw Him out.
- 13 *Then said the lord of the vineyard, What shall I do? I will send my beloved son: it may be they will reverence him when they see him.* Then the owner of the vineyard said, "What shall I do? I will send my beloved son. Perhaps they will respect Him when they see Him."
- 14 *But when the husbandmen saw him, they reasoned among themselves, saying, This is the heir: come, let us kill him, that the inheritance may be ours.* But when the farmers saw Him, they reasoned among themselves, saying, "This is the heir. Let us kill Him so that the inheritance will be ours."
- 15 *So they cast him out of the vineyard, and killed him. What therefore shall the lord of the vineyard do unto them?* So they threw Him out of the vineyard and killed Him. What then will the owner of the vineyard do to them?
- 16 *He shall come and destroy these husbandmen, and shall give the vineyard to others. And when they heard it, they said, God forbid.* He will come and destroy those farmers and give the vineyard to others. When they heard this, they said, "May that never happen!"

- 17 *And he beheld them, and said, What is this then that is written, The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner?* He looked at them and said, "What then is this that is written: 'The stone that the builders rejected has become the cornerstone'?"
- 18 *Whosoever shall fall upon that stone shall be broken; but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.* "Everyone who falls on that stone will be broken to pieces. And when it falls on anyone, it will crush him."
- 19 *And the chief priests and the scribes the same hour sought to lay hands on him; and they feared the people: for they perceived that he had spoken this parable against them.* The chief priests and the scribes wanted to arrest Him that very hour, but they feared the people. They knew he had spoken this parable against them.
- 20 *And they watched him, and sent forth spies, which should feign themselves just men, that they might take hold of his words, that so they might deliver him unto the power and authority of the governor.* They watched Him closely and sent spies who pretended to be sincere. They hoped to catch Him in something He said, so they could hand Him over to the authority of the governor.
- 21 *And they asked him, saying, Master, we know that thou sayest and teachest rightly, neither acceptest thou the person of any, but teachest the way of God truly:* They asked Him, "Master, we know that You speak and teach correctly, and that You show no partiality. You teach the way of God truthfully."
- 22 *Is it lawful for us to give tribute unto Caesar, or no?* "Is it lawful for us to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?"
- 23 *But he perceived their craftiness, and said unto them, Why tempt ye me?* He saw through their trickery and said to them, "Why do You tempt Me?"
- 24 *Shew me a penny. Whose image and superscription hath it? They answered and said, Caesar's.* "Show Me a denarius. Whose image and inscription does it have?" They answered, "Caesar's."
- 25 *And he said unto them, Render therefore unto Caesar the things which be Caesar's, and unto God the things which be God's.* He said to them, "Then give to Caesar what belongs to Caesar, and to God what belongs to God."

- 26 *And they could not take hold of his words before the people: and they marvelled at his answer, and held their peace.* They could not trap Him in His words before the people. They marveled at his answer and were silent.
- 27 *Then came to him certain of the Sadducees, which deny that there is any resurrection; and they asked him,* Some of the Sadducees — who deny that there is a resurrection — came to Him and asked,
- 28 *Saying, Master, Moses wrote unto us, If any man's brother die, having a wife, and he die without children, that his brother should take his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.* "Master, Moses wrote for us that if a man's brother dies, leaving a wife but no children, the man must marry the widow and raise up children for his brother."
- 29 *There were therefore seven brethren: and the first took a wife, and died without children.* Now there were seven brothers. The first took a wife and died without children.
- 30 *And the second took her to wife, and he died childless.* The second took her as wife, and he also died childless.
- 31 *And the third took her; and in like manner the seven also: and they left no children, and died.* The third took her, and in the same way all seven died, leaving no children.
- 32 *Last of all the woman died also.* Finally, the woman also died.
- 33 *Therefore in the resurrection whose wife of them is she? for seven had her to wife.* "In the resurrection, therefore, whose wife will she be? For all seven had her as wife."
- 34 *And Jesus answering said unto them, The children of this world marry, and are given in marriage:* Jesus said to them, "The people of this age marry and are given in marriage."
- 35 *But they which shall be accounted worthy to obtain that world, and the resurrection from the dead, neither marry, nor are given in marriage:* "But those who are considered worthy to reach that age and the resurrection from the dead neither marry nor are given in marriage."

- 36 *Neither can they die any more: for they are equal unto the angels; and are the children of God, being the children of the resurrection.* "They can no longer die, for they are like the angels. They are children of God, being children of the resurrection."
- 37 *Now that the dead are raised, even Moses shewed at the bush, when he calleth the Lord the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.* "That the dead are raised — even Moses showed this at the burning bush, when he called the Lord 'the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.'"
- 38 *For he is not a God of the dead, but of the living: for all live unto him.* "He is not the God of the dead but of the living, for all are alive to Him."
- 39 *Then certain of the scribes answering said, Master, thou hast well said.* Some of the scribes answered, "Master, you have spoken well."
- 40 *And after that they durst not ask him any question at all.* After that they did not dare to ask Him anything else.
- 41 *And he said unto them, How say they that Christ is David's son?* He said to them, "How can they say that the Christ is David's son?"
- 42 *And David himself saith in the book of Psalms, The Lord said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand,* "David himself says in the book of Psalms, 'The Lord said to my Lord, 'Sit at My right hand,'"
- 43 *Till I make thine enemies thy footstool.* "'until I make Your enemies Your footstool.'"
- 44 *David therefore calleth him Lord, how is he then his son?* "David therefore calls him Lord. How then is he his son?"
- 45 *Then in the audience of all the people he said unto his disciples,* While all the people were listening, he said to his disciples,
- 46 *Beware of the scribes, which desire to walk in long robes, and love greetings in the markets, and the highest seats in the synagogues, and the chief rooms at feasts;* "Beware of the scribes, who like to walk around in long robes and love greetings in the marketplaces, the best seats in the synagogues, and the places of honor at feasts."
- 47 *Which devour widows' houses, and for a shew make long prayers: the same shall receive greater damnation.* "They devour widows' houses and for a show make long prayers. These will receive greater damnation."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. When Jesus warns of "greater damnation," He is speaking of a heavier sentence of divine judgment.

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

Sadducees (SAD-yoo-seez) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

Cross-References:

- v9 — Matt 21:33-46; Mark 12:1-12; Isa 5:1-7
- v17 — Ps 118:22; Isa 28:16; Acts 4:11; Matt 21:42; Mark 12:10
- v18 — Isa 8:14-15; Dan 2:34-35; Zech 12:3; Matt 21:44; Dan 2:44-45
- v20 — Luke 11:54; Matt 22:15-22
- v27 — Acts 4:1-2; 1 Cor 15:12; Mark 12:18-27; Matt 22:23-33; Acts 23:6-8
- v35 — 2 Thess 1:5; Dan 12:2-3; John 5:29; Matt 12:32; Acts 24:15
- v36 — Rev 21:4; Phil 3:21; Matt 22:30
- v37 — Ex 3:2-6; Mark 12:26-27
- v38 — John 11:25-26; Col 3:3-4; Rom 6:10-11
- v42 — Ps 110:1; Acts 2:34-35; Heb 1:13; Mark 12:36-37
- v46 — Mark 12:38-39; Luke 14:7; Luke 11:43; Phil 2:3-5; Matt 23:5-7
- v47 — Mark 12:40; Jas 3:1

Chapter 21

Jesus commends a poor widow who casts two mites into the treasury, giving more than all the rest. He foretells the destruction of the temple and the signs of the end — wars, earthquakes, persecution, and Jerusalem surrounded by armies — and warns His disciples to watch and pray.

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| 1 | <i>And he looked up, and saw the rich men casting their gifts into the treasury.</i> | He looked up and saw the wealthy putting their gifts into the offering box. |
| 2 | <i>And he saw also a certain poor widow casting in thither two mites.</i> | He also saw a poor widow put in two small copper coins. |
| 3 | <i>And he said, Of a truth I say unto you, that this poor widow hath cast in more than they all:</i> | He said, "Truly I say to You, this poor widow has put in more than all of them." |

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| <p>4 <i>For all these have of their abundance cast in unto the offerings of God: but she of her penury hath cast in all the living that she had.</i></p> | <p>"For all these have given out of their abundance, but she out of her poverty has put in all the living she had."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And as some spake of the temple, how it was adorned with goodly stones and gifts, he said,</i></p> | <p>As some were speaking about the temple — how it was adorned with beautiful stones and offerings — He said,</p> |
| <p>6 <i>As for these things which ye behold, the days will come, in the which there shall not be left one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.</i></p> | <p>"As for these things that You see — the days will come when there will not be left one stone upon another that will not be thrown down."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And they asked him, saying, Master, but when shall these things be? and what sign will there be when these things shall come to pass?</i></p> | <p>They asked Him, "Master, when will these things happen? And what will be the sign when these things are about to take place?"</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And he said, Take heed that ye be not deceived: for many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them.</i></p> | <p>He said, "Watch out that You are not deceived. Many will come in My name, saying, 'I am He,' and 'The time is near.' Do not go after them."</p> |
| <p>9 <i>But when ye shall hear of wars and commotions, be not terrified: for these things must first come to pass; but the end is not by and by.</i></p> | <p>"When You hear of wars and uprisings, do not be terrified. These things must happen first, but the end will not come right away."</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Then said he unto them, Nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom:</i></p> | <p>Then He said to them, "Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom."</p> |
| <p>11 <i>And great earthquakes shall be in divers places, and famines, and pestilences; and fearful sights and great signs shall there be from heaven.</i></p> | <p>"There will be great earthquakes in various places, famines, and plagues. There will be terrifying events and great signs from heaven."</p> |

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| <p>12 <i>But before all these, they shall lay their hands on you, and persecute you, delivering you up to the synagogues, and into prisons, being brought before kings and rulers for my name's sake.</i></p> | <p>"But before all this, they will lay their hands on You and persecute You. They will hand You over to synagogues and prisons, bringing You before kings and governors because of My name."</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And it shall turn to you for a testimony.</i></p> | <p>"This will be Your opportunity to testify."</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Settle it therefore in your hearts, not to meditate before what ye shall answer:</i></p> | <p>"Settle it in Your hearts not to plan Your defense beforehand."</p> |
| <p>15 <i>For I will give you a mouth and wisdom, which all your adversaries shall not be able to gainsay nor resist.</i></p> | <p>"For I will give You words and wisdom that none of Your opponents will be able to contradict or resist."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And ye shall be betrayed both by parents, and brethren, and kinsfolks, and friends; and some of you shall they cause to be put to death.</i></p> | <p>"You will be betrayed even by parents and brothers and relatives and friends. Some of You will be put to death."</p> |
| <p>17 <i>And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake.</i></p> | <p>"You will be hated by everyone because of My name."</p> |
| <p>18 <i>But there shall not an hair of your head perish.</i></p> | <p>"But not a hair of Your head will perish."</p> |
| <p>19 <i>In your patience possess ye your souls.</i></p> | <p>"By Your endurance You will gain Your lives."</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And when ye shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies, then know that the desolation thereof is nigh.</i></p> | <p>"When You see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, know that its destruction is near."</p> |
| <p>21 <i>Then let them which are in Judaea flee to the mountains; and let them which are in the midst of it depart out; and let not them that are in the countries enter thereinto.</i></p> | <p>"Then let those who are in Judaea flee to the mountains. Let those who are inside the city get out. Let those who are in the countryside not enter it."</p> |

- 22 *For these be the days of vengeance, that all things which are written may be fulfilled.* "For these are days of vengeance, to fulfill everything that is written."
- 23 *But woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck, in those days! for there shall be great distress in the land, and wrath upon this people.* "How terrible it will be for those who are pregnant and for nursing mothers in those days! For there will be great distress in the land and wrath against this people."
- 24 *And they shall fall by the edge of the sword, and shall be led away captive into all nations: and Jerusalem shall be trodden down of the Gentiles, until the times of the Gentiles be fulfilled.* "They will fall by the edge of the sword and be led captive into all nations. Jerusalem will be trampled by the Gentiles until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled."
- 25 *And there shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations, with perplexity; the sea and the waves roaring;* "There will be signs in the sun, moon, and stars. On earth the nations will be in anguish and confusion as the seas roar and toss."
- 26 *Men's hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after those things which are coming on the earth: for the powers of heaven shall be shaken.* "People will faint from terror at what is coming on the earth, for the powers of the heavens will be shaken."
- 27 *And then shall they see the Son of man coming in a cloud with power and great glory.* "Then they will see the Son of Man coming in a cloud with power and great glory."
- 28 *And when these things begin to come to pass, then look up, and lift up your heads; for your redemption draweth nigh.* "When these things begin to happen, stand up and lift Your heads, because Your redemption is drawing near."
- 29 *And he spake to them a parable; Behold the fig tree, and all the trees;* He told them a parable: "Look at the fig tree and all the trees."
- 30 *When they now shoot forth, ye see and know of your own selves that summer is now nigh at hand.* "When they put out leaves, You see for yourselves and know that summer is already near."

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| <p>31 <i>So likewise ye, when ye see these things come to pass, know ye that the kingdom of God is nigh at hand.</i></p> | <p>"So also, when You see these things happening, know that the kingdom of God is near."</p> |
| <p>32 <i>Verily I say unto you, This generation shall not pass away, till all be fulfilled.</i></p> | <p>"Truly I say to You, this generation will not pass away until all has been fulfilled."</p> |
| <p>33 <i>Heaven and earth shall pass away: but my words shall not pass away.</i></p> | <p>"Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will never pass away."</p> |
| <p>34 <i>And take heed to yourselves, lest at any time your hearts be overcharged with surfeiting, and drunkenness, and cares of this life, and so that day come upon you unawares.</i></p> | <p>"Be careful, or Your hearts will be weighed down with carousing, drunkenness, and the worries of this life. That day will close on You suddenly."</p> |
| <p>35 <i>For as a snare shall it come on all them that dwell on the face of the whole earth.</i></p> | <p>"For it will come like a trap on everyone who lives on the face of the whole earth."</p> |
| <p>36 <i>Watch ye therefore, and pray always, that ye may be accounted worthy to escape all these things that shall come to pass, and to stand before the Son of man.</i></p> | <p>"So watch at all times, and pray that You may be counted worthy to escape all these things that will happen, and to stand before the Son of Man."</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And in the day time he was teaching in the temple; and at night he went out, and abode in the mount that is called the mount of Olives.</i></p> | <p>Every day He was teaching in the temple. At night He went out and stayed on the mount called the Mount of Olives.</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And all the people came early in the morning to him in the temple, for to hear him.</i></p> | <p>All the people came to him early in the morning at the temple to hear Him.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v8 — 1 John 4:1; Eph 5:6; 2 Thess 2:3; Mark 13:5-6; Mark 13:21-23
- v15 — Jer 1:9; Eph 6:19; Luke 12:12; Acts 6:10; Ex 4:11-12
- v19 — Heb 10:36; Jas 1:3; Matt 10:22; Rom 5:3; Rev 3:10
- v22 — Hos 9:7; Isa 65:12-16; Isa 34:8; 2 Pet 2:9; Isa 63:4
- v24 — Rom 11:25; Rev 11:2; Isa 63:18; Dan 12:7; Dan 9:27
- v25 — Isa 13:10; Joel 2:30-31; Rev 6:12-14; Ezek 32:7-8; Isa 24:23
- v27 — Rev 1:7; Matt 24:30; Mark 13:26; Matt 26:64; Dan 7:13
- v31 — Jas 5:9; Heb 10:37
- v32 — Mark 13:30; Matt 24:34; Matt 23:36; Matt 16:28
- v33 — Isa 40:8; Mark 13:31; Matt 24:35; Isa 51:6; Ps 102:26
- v34 — Mark 4:19; Luke 12:45-46; 1 Thess 5:2-8; Luke 12:40; 1 Pet 4:3-7
- v36 — 1 John 2:28; Matt 25:13; 1 Pet 5:8; Matt 24:42; 1 Pet 4:7

Chapter 22

Judas agrees to betray Jesus for money, and Jesus observes the Last Supper with His disciples, instituting the new covenant in His blood. He prays in agony on the Mount of Olives, is betrayed by Judas, arrested, denied three times by Peter, and beaten and mocked by the guards.

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| 1 | <i>Now the feast of unleavened bread drew nigh, which is called the Passover.</i> | The Feast of Unleavened Bread, called the Passover, was drawing near. |
| 2 | <i>And the chief priests and scribes sought how they might kill him; for they feared the people.</i> | The chief priests and scribes were looking for a way to kill Him, because they feared the people. |
| 3 | <i>Then entered Satan into Judas surnamed Iscariot, being of the number of the twelve.</i> | Then Satan entered into Judas, who was called Iscariot, one of the twelve. |
| 4 | <i>And he went his way, and communed with the chief priests and captains, how he might betray him unto them.</i> | He went away and discussed with the chief priests and officers how He might betray Jesus to them. |
| 5 | <i>And they were glad, and covenanted to give him money.</i> | They were glad and agreed to give Him money. |
| 6 | <i>And he promised, and sought opportunity to betray him unto them in the absence of the multitude.</i> | He agreed and looked for an opportunity to betray Him when the crowd was not around. |

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| <p>7 <i>Then came the day of unleavened bread, when the passover must be killed.</i></p> | <p>The day of Unleavened Bread came, when the Passover lamb had to be sacrificed.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And he sent Peter and John, saying, Go and prepare us the passover, that we may eat.</i></p> | <p>He sent Peter and John, saying, "Go and prepare the Passover for us, so we may eat it."</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And they said unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare?</i></p> | <p>They said to Him, "Where do You want us to prepare it?"</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And he said unto them, Behold, when ye are entered into the city, there shall a man meet you, bearing a pitcher of water; follow him into the house where he entereth in.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "When you enter the city, a man carrying a jar of water will meet you. Follow him into the house he enters."</p> |
| <p>11 <i>And ye shall say unto the goodman of the house, The Master saith unto thee, Where is the guestchamber, where I shall eat the passover with my disciples?</i></p> | <p>"Say to the owner of the house, 'The Master asks you: Where is the guest room where I may eat the Passover with My disciples?'"</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And he shall shew you a large upper room furnished: there make ready.</i></p> | <p>"He will show you a large upper room that is furnished. Prepare it there."</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And they went, and found as he had said unto them: and they made ready the passover.</i></p> | <p>They went and found it just as He had told them, and they prepared the Passover.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>And when the hour was come, he sat down, and the twelve apostles with him.</i></p> | <p>When the hour came, He reclined at the table, and the twelve apostles were with Him.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And he said unto them, With desire I have desired to eat this passover with you before I suffer:</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "I have eagerly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>For I say unto you, I will not any more eat thereof, until it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>"For I tell you, I will not eat it again until it is fulfilled in the kingdom of God."</p> |

- 17 *And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and said, Take this, and divide it among yourselves:* He took the cup and gave thanks and said, "Take this and share it among yourselves."
- 18 *For I say unto you, I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, until the kingdom of God shall come.* "For I tell you that from now on I will not drink of the fruit of the vine until the kingdom of God comes."
- 19 *And he took bread, and gave thanks, and brake it, and gave unto them, saying, This is my body which is given for you: this do in remembrance of me.* He took bread, gave thanks, broke it, and gave it to them, saying, "This is My body, which is given for you. Do this in remembrance of Me."
- 20 *Likewise also the cup after supper, saying, This cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you.* In the same way, He took the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new testament in My blood, which is shed for you."
- 21 *But, behold, the hand of him that betrayeth me is with me on the table.* "But the hand of the one who betrays Me is with Me on the table."
- 22 *And truly the Son of man goeth, as it was determined: but woe unto that man by whom he is betrayed!* "The Son of Man goes as it has been determined, but woe to that man by whom he is betrayed!"
- 23 *And they began to enquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing.* They began to ask one another which of them it was who would do this.
- 24 *And there was also a strife among them, which of them should be accounted the greatest.* A dispute also arose among them as to which of them was to be considered the greatest.
- 25 *And he said unto them, The kings of the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and they that exercise authority upon them are called benefactors.* He said to them, "The kings of the Gentiles lord it over them, and those who have authority over them are called benefactors."
- 26 *But ye shall not be so: but he that is greatest among you, let him be as the younger; and he that is chief, as he that doth serve.* "But it must not be that way among You. Instead, the greatest among You must be like the youngest, and the leader like the one who serves."

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| <p>27 <i>For whether is greater, he that sitteth at meat, or he that serveth? is not he that sitteth at meat? but I am among you as he that serveth.</i></p> | <p>"For who is greater — the one who reclines at the table or the one who serves? Is it not the one who reclines? But I am among you as the One who serves."</p> |
| <p>28 <i>Ye are they which have continued with me in my temptations.</i></p> | <p>"You are those who have stood by Me through My trials."</p> |
| <p>29 <i>And I appoint unto you a kingdom, as my Father hath appointed unto me;</i></p> | <p>"I appoint to You a kingdom, just as My Father has appointed one to Me."</p> |
| <p>30 <i>That ye may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.</i></p> | <p>"You will eat and drink at My table in My kingdom, and You will sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel."</p> |
| <p>31 <i>And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat:</i></p> | <p>The Lord said, "Simon, Simon, Satan has asked to sift you as wheat."</p> |
| <p>32 <i>But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when thou art converted, strengthen thy brethren.</i></p> | <p>"But I have prayed for you that your faith will not fail. And when you have turned back, strengthen your brothers."</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And he said unto him, Lord, I am ready to go with thee, both into prison, and to death.</i></p> | <p>He said to Him, "Lord, I am ready to go with You both to prison and to death."</p> |
| <p>34 <i>And he said, I tell thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, before that thou shalt thrice deny that thou knowest me.</i></p> | <p>He said, "I tell you, Peter, the rooster will not crow today before you deny three times that you know Me."</p> |
| <p>35 <i>And he said unto them, When I sent you without purse, and scrip, and shoes, lacked ye any thing? And they said, Nothing.</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "When I sent you out without purse, bag, or sandals, did you lack anything?" They said, "Nothing."</p> |

- 36 *Then said he unto them, But now, he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise his scrip: and he that hath no sword, let him sell his garment, and buy one.* He said to them, "But now, let the one who has a purse take it, and likewise a bag. And let the one who has no sword sell his cloak and buy one."
- 37 *For I say unto you, that this that is written must yet be accomplished in me, And he was reckoned among the transgressors: for the things concerning me have an end.* "For I tell you that this Scripture must be fulfilled in Me: 'And He was numbered with the transgressors.' What is written about Me is reaching its fulfillment."
- 38 *And they said, Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said unto them, It is enough.* They said, "Lord, look, here are two swords." He said to them, "That is enough."
- 39 *And he came out, and went, as he was wont, to the mount of Olives; and his disciples also followed him.* He went out and made His way, as was His custom, to the Mount of Olives. His disciples followed Him.
- 40 *And when he was at the place, he said unto them, Pray that ye enter not into temptation.* When He arrived at the place, He said to them, "Pray that you do not enter into temptation."
- 41 *And he was withdrawn from them about a stone's cast, and kneeled down, and prayed,* He withdrew from them about a stone's throw away, knelt down, and prayed.
- 42 *Saying, Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me: nevertheless not my will, but thine, be done.* He said, "Father, if You are willing, remove this cup from Me. Yet not My will, but Yours, be done."
- 43 *And there appeared an angel unto him from heaven, strengthening him.* An angel from heaven appeared to Him, strengthening Him.
- 44 *And being in an agony he prayed more earnestly: and his sweat was as it were great drops of blood falling down to the ground.* Being in agony, He prayed more earnestly. His sweat became like great drops of blood falling down to the ground.
- 45 *And when he rose up from prayer, and was come to his disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow,* When He rose from prayer and came to His disciples, He found them asleep, exhausted from grief.

- 46 *And said unto them, Why sleep ye? rise and pray, lest ye enter into temptation.* He said to them, "Why are you sleeping? Get up and pray that you do not enter into temptation."
- 47 *And while he yet spake, behold a multitude, and he that was called Judas, one of the twelve, went before them, and drew near unto Jesus to kiss him.* While He was still speaking, a crowd arrived. The one called Judas, one of the twelve, was leading them. He came close to Jesus to kiss Him.
- 48 *But Jesus said unto him, Judas, betrayest thou the Son of man with a kiss?* But Jesus said to Him, "Judas, are you betraying the Son of Man with a kiss?"
- 49 *When they which were about him saw what would follow, they said unto him, Lord, shall we smite with the sword?* When those around Him saw what was about to happen, they said, "Lord, shall we strike with the sword?"
- 50 *And one of them smote the servant of the high priest, and cut off his right ear.* One of them struck the servant of the high priest and cut off his right ear.
- 51 *And Jesus answered and said, Suffer ye thus far. And he touched his ear, and healed him.* Jesus answered, "No more of this!" He touched the man's ear and healed him.
- 52 *Then Jesus said unto the chief priests, and captains of the temple, and the elders, which were come to him, Be ye come out, as against a thief, with swords and staves?* Jesus said to the chief priests, the officers of the temple, and the elders who had come to seize Him, "Have You come out with swords and clubs as if You were coming against a robber?"
- 53 *When I was daily with you in the temple, ye stretched forth no hands against me: but this is your hour, and the power of darkness.* "Every day I was with You in the temple, and You did not lay a hand on Me. But this is Your hour — the time when darkness rules."
- 54 *Then took they him, and led him, and brought him into the high priest's house. And Peter followed afar off.* They seized Him, led Him away, and brought Him into the high priest's house. Peter followed at a distance.

- 55 *And when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the hall, and were set down together, Peter sat down among them.* When they had lit a fire in the middle of the courtyard and sat down together, Peter sat among them.
- 56 *But a certain maid beheld him as he sat by the fire, and earnestly looked upon him, and said, This man was also with him.* A servant girl saw him sitting by the fire. She stared at him and said, "This man was with him too."
- 57 *And he denied him, saying, Woman, I know him not.* He denied it, saying, "Woman, I do not know Him."
- 58 *And after a little while another saw him, and said, Thou art also of them. And Peter said, Man, I am not.* A little later someone else saw him and said, "You are one of them too." Peter said, "Man, I am not."
- 59 *And about the space of one hour after another confidently affirmed, saying, Of a truth this fellow also was with him: for he is a Galilaean.* About an hour later someone else insisted, "This man was certainly with him, for he is a Galilean."
- 60 *And Peter said, Man, I know not what thou sayest. And immediately, while he yet spake, the cock crew.* Peter said, "Man, I do not know what you are saying." Immediately, while he was still speaking, the rooster crowed.
- 61 *And the Lord turned, and looked upon Peter. And Peter remembered the word of the Lord, how he had said unto him, Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.* The Lord turned and looked at Peter. Peter remembered the word of the Lord — how he had said to Him, "Before the rooster crows today, you will deny Me three times."
- 62 *And Peter went out, and wept bitterly.* Peter went out and wept bitterly.
- 63 *And the men that held Jesus mocked him, and smote him.* The men who were holding Jesus mocked Him and struck Him.
- 64 *And when they had blindfolded him, they struck him on the face, and asked him, saying, Prophecy, who is it that smote thee?* They blindfolded Him, hit Him, and demanded, "Prophecy! Who struck You?"
- 65 *And many other things blasphemously spake they against him.* They said many other blasphemous things against Him.

66	<i>And as soon as it was day, the elders of the people and the chief priests and the scribes came together, and led him into their council, saying,</i>	When day came, the elders of the people — the chief priests and scribes — assembled together and led Him before their council.
67	<i>Art thou the Christ? tell us. And he said unto them, If I tell you, ye will not believe:</i>	They said, "If You are the Christ, tell us." He said to them, "If I tell You, You will not believe."
68	<i>And if I also ask you, ye will not answer me, nor let me go.</i>	"And if I ask You, You will not answer Me or let Me go."
69	<i>Hereafter shall the Son of man sit on the right hand of the power of God.</i>	"But from now on, the Son of Man will be seated at the right hand of the power of God."
70	<i>Then said they all, Art thou then the Son of God? And he said unto them, Ye say that I am.</i>	They all said, "Are You then the Son of God?" He said to them, "You say that I am."
71	<i>And they said, What need we any further witness? for we ourselves have heard of his own mouth.</i>	They said, "What further need do we have of testimony? We have heard it ourselves from His own mouth."

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Cross-References:

v3 — John 13:2; Mark 14:10-11; John 13:18; Ps 55:12-14; John 13:26-27
v19 — 1 Cor 11:23-29; 1 Cor 10:16; Mark 14:22-24; Luke 22:20; Matt 26:26-28
v20 — Matt 26:28; 1 Cor 11:25; Zech 9:11; Heb 13:20; Ex 24:8
v29 — Matt 25:34; 2 Tim 2:12; Jas 2:5; Matt 24:47; Matt 28:18
v31 — 1 Pet 5:8; Zech 3:1; Job 1:6-12; Rev 12:10; Job 2:1-6
v32 — John 21:15-17; 1 Pet 5:8-10; John 17:9-11; Rom 8:34; 2 Cor 1:4-6
v37 — Isa 53:12; Luke 23:32; 2 Cor 5:21; Gal 3:13; Acts 13:27-29
v40 — Matt 6:13; Matt 26:36-46; Luke 22:46; Mark 14:32-42; 2 Cor 12:7-10
v42 — John 12:27-28; Matt 26:39; Matt 26:42; Mark 14:36; Ps 40:8
v43 — Matt 4:11; Matt 26:53; Heb 1:14; Ps 91:11-12; 1 Tim 3:16
v44 — Lam 1:12; Heb 5:7; Ps 22:12-21; Rom 8:32; John 12:27

v69 — Ps 110:1; Dan 7:13-14; Mark 16:19; Heb 1:3; Matt 26:64

Chapter 23

Jesus is brought before Pilate and Herod, who find no fault in Him, but the crowd demands His crucifixion and the release of Barabbas. Jesus is crucified between two thieves, and one repents and is promised paradise. Jesus commits His spirit to the Father and dies, and Joseph of Arimathaea buries Him.

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| 1 | <i>And the whole multitude of them arose, and led him unto Pilate.</i> | The whole assembly rose and brought Him before Pilate. |
| 2 | <i>And they began to accuse him, saying, We found this fellow perverting the nation, and forbidding to give tribute to Caesar, saying that he himself is Christ a King.</i> | They began to accuse Him, saying, "We found this man misleading our nation, forbidding us to pay taxes to Caesar, and saying that He Himself is Christ, a king." |
| 3 | <i>And Pilate asked him, saying, Art thou the King of the Jews? And he answered him and said, Thou sayest it.</i> | Pilate asked him, "Are you the King of the Jews?" He answered him, "You say so." |
| 4 | <i>Then said Pilate to the chief priests and to the people, I find no fault in this man.</i> | Then Pilate said to the chief priests and the crowd, "I find no guilt in this man." |
| 5 | <i>And they were the more fierce, saying, He stirreth up the people, teaching throughout all Jewry, beginning from Galilee to this place.</i> | They pressed harder, saying, "He stirs up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, from Galilee all the way to this place." |
| 6 | <i>When Pilate heard of Galilee, he asked whether the man were a Galilaean.</i> | When Pilate heard "Galilee," he asked whether the man was a Galilean. |
| 7 | <i>And as soon as he knew that he belonged unto Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to Herod, who himself also was at Jerusalem at that time.</i> | When He learned that Jesus was under Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to Herod, who was also in Jerusalem at that time. |

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| <p>8 <i>And when Herod saw Jesus, he was exceeding glad: for he was desirous to see him of a long season, because he had heard many things of him; and he hoped to have seen some miracle done by him.</i></p> | <p>When Herod saw Jesus, He was greatly pleased, for He had wanted to see Him for a long time. He had heard many things about Him and hoped to see some miracle performed by Him.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Then he questioned with him in many words; but he answered him nothing.</i></p> | <p>He questioned Jesus at length, but Jesus gave Him no answer.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>And the chief priests and scribes stood and vehemently accused him.</i></p> | <p>The chief priests and scribes stood there, accusing Him forcefully.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>And Herod with his men of war set him at nought, and mocked him, and arrayed him in a gorgeous robe, and sent him again to Pilate.</i></p> | <p>Herod and his soldiers treated him with contempt and mocked Him. They put a splendid robe on Him and sent Him back to Pilate.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And the same day Pilate and Herod were made friends together: for before they were at enmity between themselves.</i></p> | <p>That same day Pilate and Herod became friends with each other. Before this, they had been enemies.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>And Pilate, when he had called together the chief priests and the rulers and the people,</i></p> | <p>Pilate called together the chief priests, the rulers, and the people.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Said unto them, Ye have brought this man unto me, as one that perverteth the people: and, behold, I, having examined him before you, have found no fault in this man touching those things whereof ye accuse him:</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "You brought this man to me as one who was misleading the people. I have examined him before you and found no guilt in Him regarding the charges you bring against Him."</p> |
| <p>15 <i>No, nor yet Herod: for I sent you to him; and, lo, nothing worthy of death is done unto him.</i></p> | <p>"Neither has Herod, for he sent him back to us. He has done nothing deserving of death."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>I will therefore chastise him, and release him.</i></p> | <p>"I will therefore punish Him and release Him."</p> |
| <p>17 <i>(For of necessity he must release one unto them at the feast.)</i></p> | <p>For it was necessary for him to release one prisoner to them at the feast.</p> |

- 18 *And they cried out all at once, saying, Away with this man, and release unto us Barabbas:* They all cried out together, "Away with this man! Release Barabbas to us!"

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Barabbas** (buh-RAB-us) — "son of the father" — A notorious prisoner who had been put in prison for insurrection and murder. The crowd chose his release over Jesus.

- 19 *(Who for a certain sedition made in the city, and for murder, was cast into prison.)* This was a man who had been thrown into prison for a rebellion in the city and for murder.
- 20 *Pilate therefore, willing to release Jesus, spake again to them.* Pilate, wanting to release Jesus, spoke to them again.
- 21 *But they cried, saying, Crucify him, crucify him.* But they kept shouting, "Crucify Him! Crucify Him!"
- 22 *And he said unto them the third time, Why, what evil hath he done? I have found no cause of death in him: I will therefore chastise him, and let him go.* A third time He said to them, "Why? What wrong has He done? I have found no reason to put Him to death. I will therefore punish Him and release Him."
- 23 *And they were instant with loud voices, requiring that he might be crucified. And the voices of them and of the chief priests prevailed.* But they kept urgently demanding with loud voices that He be crucified. Their voices and the voices of the chief priests won out.
- 24 *And Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they required.* Pilate gave his verdict that their demand should be granted.
- 25 *And he released unto them him that for sedition and murder was cast into prison, whom they had desired; but he delivered Jesus to their will.* He released the man who had been thrown in prison for rebellion and murder — the one they demanded — and He handed Jesus over to their will.
- 26 *And as they led him away, they laid hold upon one Simon, a Cyrenian, coming out of the country, and on him they laid the cross, that he might bear it after Jesus.* As they led Him away, they seized a man named Simon of Cyrene, who was coming in from the country, and placed the cross on Him to carry it behind Jesus.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Simon of Cyrene** (SY-ren-ee) — A man from Cyrene in North Africa who was compelled to carry Jesus' cross. His sons Alexander and Rufus were apparently known to the early church (Mark 15:21).

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| <p>27 <i>And there followed him a great company of people, and of women, which also bewailed and lamented him.</i></p> | <p>A great crowd of people followed Him, including women who were mourning and weeping for Him.</p> |
| <p>28 <i>But Jesus turning unto them said, Daughters of Jerusalem, weep not for me, but weep for yourselves, and for your children.</i></p> | <p>But Jesus turned to them and said, "Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for Me. Weep for yourselves and for Your children."</p> |
| <p>29 <i>For, behold, the days are coming, in the which they shall say, Blessed are the barren, and the wombs that never bare, and the paps which never gave suck.</i></p> | <p>"For the days are coming when they will say, 'Blessed are the barren women, the wombs that never bore children, and the breasts that never nursed.'"</p> |
| <p>30 <i>Then shall they begin to say to the mountains, Fall on us; and to the hills, Cover us.</i></p> | <p>"Then they will begin to say to the mountains, 'Fall on us!' and to the hills, 'Cover us!'"</p> |
| <p>31 <i>For if they do these things in a green tree, what shall be done in the dry?</i></p> | <p>"For if they do these things when the wood is green, what will happen when it is dry?"</p> |
| <p>32 <i>And there were also two other, malefactors, led with him to be put to death.</i></p> | <p>Two others — criminals — were also led out to be put to death with Him.</p> |
| <p>33 <i>And when they were come to the place, which is called Calvary, there they crucified him, and the malefactors, one on the right hand, and the other on the left.</i></p> | <p>When they came to the place called Calvary, they crucified Him there, along with the criminals — one on His right and one on His left.</p> |
| <p>34 <i>Then said Jesus, Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do. And they parted his raiment, and cast lots.</i></p> | <p>Jesus said, "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing." They divided His clothes by casting lots.</p> |

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| <p>35 <i>And the people stood beholding. And the rulers also with them derided him, saying, He saved others; let him save himself, if he be Christ, the chosen of God.</i></p> | <p>The people stood watching. The rulers sneered at him, saying, "He saved others. Let Him save Himself, if He is the Christ of God, His Chosen One."</p> |
| <p>36 <i>And the soldiers also mocked him, coming to him, and offering him vinegar,</i></p> | <p>The soldiers also mocked Him, coming up and offering Him sour wine.</p> |
| <p>37 <i>And saying, If thou be the king of the Jews, save thyself.</i></p> | <p>They said, "If You are the King of the Jews, save yourself."</p> |
| <p>38 <i>And a superscription also was written over him in letters of Greek, and Latin, and Hebrew, THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.</i></p> | <p>A sign was also written over Him in letters of Greek, Latin, and Hebrew: THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.</p> |
| <p>39 <i>And one of the malefactors which were hanged railed on him, saying, If thou be Christ, save thyself and us.</i></p> | <p>One of the criminals hanging there railed at Him, saying, "If You are the Christ, save Yourself and us!"</p> |
| <p>40 <i>But the other answering rebuked him, saying, Dost not thou fear God, seeing thou art in the same condemnation?</i></p> | <p>But the other rebuked Him, saying, "Do You not fear God, since You are under the same sentence of condemnation?"</p> |
| <p>41 <i>And we indeed justly; for we receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing amiss.</i></p> | <p>"We are receiving what our deeds deserve. But this man has done nothing wrong."</p> |
| <p>42 <i>And he said unto Jesus, Lord, remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom.</i></p> | <p>He said, "Jesus, remember me when You come into Your kingdom."</p> |
| <p>43 <i>And Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, To day shalt thou be with me in paradise.</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to Him, "Truly I say to You, today You will be with Me in paradise."</p> |
| <p>44 <i>And it was about the sixth hour, and there was a darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour.</i></p> | <p>It was about the sixth hour, and darkness came over the whole land until the ninth hour.</p> |

- 45 *And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was rent in the midst.* The sun was darkened, and the curtain of the temple was torn in two.
- 46 *And when Jesus had cried with a loud voice, he said, Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost.* Jesus cried out with a loud voice, "Father, into Your hands I commit My spirit." Having said this, He breathed His last.
- 47 *Now when the centurion saw what was done, he glorified God, saying, Certainly this was a righteous man.* When the centurion saw what had happened, he praised God, saying, "Certainly this was a righteous man."
- 48 *And all the people that came together to that sight, beholding the things which were done, smote their breasts, and returned.* All the crowds who had gathered for this spectacle, when they saw what had taken place, went home beating their chests.
- 49 *And all his acquaintance, and the women that followed him from Galilee, stood afar off, beholding these things.* All those who knew Him, including the women who had followed Him from Galilee, stood at a distance, watching these things.
- 50 *And, behold, there was a man named Joseph, a counsellor; and he was a good man, and a just:* There was a man named Joseph, a member of the council. He was a good and righteous man.
- 51 *(The same had not consented to the counsel and deed of them;) he was of Arimathaea, a city of the Jews: who also himself waited for the kingdom of God.* He had not agreed with their decision and action. He was from Arimathaea, a town in Judea, and he was waiting for the kingdom of God.
- 52 *This man went unto Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus.* This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.
- 53 *And he took it down, and wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a sepulchre that was hewn in stone, wherein never man before was laid.* He took it down and wrapped it in linen cloth. He placed it in a tomb cut from rock, in which no one had ever been laid.
- 54 *And that day was the preparation, and the sabbath drew on.* That day was the Preparation Day, and the Sabbath was beginning.

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| 55 | <i>And the women also, which came with him from Galilee, followed after, and beheld the sepulchre, and how his body was laid.</i> | The women who had come with Him from Galilee followed and saw the tomb and how His body was placed. |
| 56 | <i>And they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the sabbath day according to the commandment.</i> | Then they went back and prepared spices and ointments. On the Sabbath they rested, according to the commandment. |

Words in this chapter:

Simon of Cyrene (*sy-REEN*) — A man from Cyrene (North Africa) who was compelled by Roman soldiers to carry Jesus's cross to Golgotha.

Calvary (*KAL-vah-ree*) — The Latin translation of Golgotha — 'place of the skull'; the hill outside Jerusalem where Jesus was crucified; only used in Luke 23:33 in the KJV.

Cross-References:

- v24 — Matt 27:26; Prov 17:15; Ex 23:2; Mark 15:15
- v29 — Matt 24:19; Luke 21:23-24; Mark 13:17-19; Hos 9:12-16; Hos 13:16
- v30 — Rev 6:16; Hos 10:8; Isa 2:19; Rev 9:6
- v31 — 1 Pet 4:17-18; John 15:6; Prov 11:31; Ezek 20:47-48
- v32 — Mark 15:27; Matt 27:38; Isa 53:12; John 19:18
- v34 — Matt 5:44; Acts 7:60; 1 Pet 3:9; 1 Pet 2:20-23; Luke 6:27-28
- v35 — Ps 22:17; Isa 42:1; 1 Pet 2:4; Mark 15:29-32; Matt 12:18
- v42 — Rom 10:9-14; Acts 16:31; 1 John 5:11-13; 1 Cor 6:10-11; Luke 12:8
- v43 — Rev 2:7; Ps 50:15; 1 Tim 1:15-16; Luke 19:10; Ps 32:5
- v44 — Matt 27:45; Mark 15:33-34; Amos 8:9; Acts 2:20; Matt 27:52
- v45 — Heb 10:19-22; Matt 27:51; Heb 9:3-8; Mark 15:38
- v46 — Ps 31:5; Acts 7:59; John 19:30; 1 Pet 2:23; Mark 15:34-41

Chapter 24

Women come to the tomb on the first day of the week and find it empty, and two angels announce that Jesus has risen. The risen Jesus walks with two disciples on the road to Emmaus and reveals Himself to them in the breaking of bread. He appears to the gathered disciples, commissions them as witnesses, and ascends into heaven from Bethany.

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| <p>1 <i>Now upon the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came unto the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared, and certain others with them.</i></p> | <p>On the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came to the tomb, bringing the spices they had prepared. Some others came with them.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And they found the stone rolled away from the sepulchre.</i></p> | <p>They found the stone rolled away from the tomb.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they entered in, and found not the body of the Lord Jesus.</i></p> | <p>When they entered, they did not find the body of the Lord Jesus.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And it came to pass, as they were much perplexed thereabout, behold, two men stood by them in shining garments:</i></p> | <p>While they were puzzled about this, two men in dazzling clothing suddenly stood by them.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And as they were afraid, and bowed down their faces to the earth, they said unto them, Why seek ye the living among the dead?</i></p> | <p>The women were terrified and bowed their faces to the ground. The men said to them, "Why do You seek the living among the dead?"</p> |
| <p>6 <i>He is not here, but is risen: remember how he spake unto you when he was yet in Galilee,</i></p> | <p>"He is not here. He has risen! Remember how He spoke to You when He was still in Galilee."</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Saying, The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, and be crucified, and the third day rise again.</i></p> | <p>"He said, 'The Son of Man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, be crucified, and on the third day rise again.'"</p> |
| <p>8 <i>And they remembered his words,</i></p> | <p>They remembered His words.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>And returned from the sepulchre, and told all these things unto the eleven, and to all the rest.</i></p> | <p>They returned from the tomb and reported all these things to the eleven and to all the rest.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>It was Mary Magdalene, and Joanna, and Mary the mother of James, and other women that were with them, which told these things unto the apostles.</i></p> | <p>These women were Mary Magdalene, Joanna, and Mary the mother of James. The other women with them also told these things to the apostles.</p> |

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| <p>11 <i>And their words seemed to them as idle tales, and they believed them not.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Then arose Peter, and ran unto the sepulchre; and stooping down, he beheld the linen clothes laid by themselves, and departed, wondering in himself at that which was come to pass.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And, behold, two of them went that same day to a village called Emmaus, which was from Jerusalem about threescore furlongs.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And they talked together of all these things which had happened.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And it came to pass, that, while they communed together and reasoned, Jesus himself drew near, and went with them.</i></p> <p>16 <i>But their eyes were holden that they should not know him.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And he said unto them, What manner of communications are these that ye have one to another, as ye walk, and are sad?</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the one of them, whose name was Cleopas, answering said unto him, Art thou only a stranger in Jerusalem, and hast not known the things which are come to pass there in these days?</i></p> | <p>But these words seemed like nonsense to the apostles, and they did not believe the women.</p> <p>Peter got up and ran to the tomb. Stooping down, he saw only the linen cloths lying there. He went away, wondering to himself about what had happened.</p> <p>That same day, two of them were going to a village called Emmaus, about seven miles from Jerusalem.</p> <p>They were talking with each other about everything that had happened.</p> <p>While they were talking and discussing these things, Jesus Himself drew near and walked with them.</p> <p>But their eyes were kept from recognizing Him.</p> <p>He said to them, "What manner of conversation is this that You have with one another as You walk, and are sad?"</p> <p>One of them, named Cleopas, answered Him, "Are You the only visitor to Jerusalem who does not know the things that have happened there in these days?"</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cleopas** (KLEE-oh-pas) — One of the two disciples traveling to Emmaus on the day of the resurrection. He is not one of the twelve apostles; his identity beyond this passage is uncertain.

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| <p>19 <i>And he said unto them, What things? And they said unto him, Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, which was a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people:</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "What things?" They said to Him, "Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people."</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And how the chief priests and our rulers delivered him to be condemned to death, and have crucified him.</i></p> | <p>"How the chief priests and our rulers handed Him over to be condemned to death, and they crucified Him."</p> |
| <p>21 <i>But we trusted that it had been he which should have redeemed Israel: and beside all this, to day is the third day since these things were done.</i></p> | <p>"We had hoped that He was the one to redeem Israel. Besides all this, it is now the third day since these things happened."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>Yea, and certain women also of our company made us astonished, which were early at the sepulchre;</i></p> | <p>"Some women from our group also astonished us. They were at the tomb early this morning."</p> |
| <p>23 <i>And when they found not his body, they came, saying, that they had also seen a vision of angels, which said that he was alive.</i></p> | <p>"When they did not find His body, they came back saying they had seen a vision of angels who said He was alive."</p> |
| <p>24 <i>And certain of them which were with us went to the sepulchre, and found it even so as the women had said: but him they saw not.</i></p> | <p>"Some of those who were with us went to the tomb and found it just as the women had said, but they did not see Him."</p> |
| <p>25 <i>Then he said unto them, O fools, and slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have spoken:</i></p> | <p>He said to them, "How foolish You are, and how slow of heart to believe everything the prophets have spoken!"</p> |
| <p>26 <i>Ought not Christ to have suffered these things, and to enter into his glory?</i></p> | <p>"Was it not necessary for the Christ to suffer these things and then enter into His glory?"</p> |
| <p>27 <i>And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.</i></p> | <p>Beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was written about Himself throughout all the Scriptures.</p> |

- 28 *And they drew nigh unto the village, whither they went: and he made as though he would have gone further.* They drew near to the village they were heading to, and He acted as though He would go on further.
- 29 *But they constrained him, saying, Abide with us: for it is toward evening, and the day is far spent. And he went in to tarry with them.* But they urged Him, saying, "Stay with us, for it is toward evening and the day is nearly over." So He went in to stay with them.
- 30 *And it came to pass, as he sat at meat with them, he took bread, and blessed it, and brake, and gave to them.* While He was at the table with them, He took bread, blessed it, broke it, and gave it to them.
- 31 *And their eyes were opened, and they knew him; and he vanished out of their sight.* Their eyes were opened and they recognized Him. Then He vanished from their sight.
- 32 *And they said one to another, Did not our heart burn within us, while he talked with us by the way, and while he opened to us the scriptures?* They said to each other, "Were not our hearts burning within us while He talked with us on the road and opened the Scriptures to us?"
- 33 *And they rose up the same hour, and returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together, and them that were with them,* They got up that very hour and returned to Jerusalem. They found the eleven and those with them gathered together.
- 34 *Saying, The Lord is risen indeed, and hath appeared to Simon.* These were saying, "The Lord has truly risen and has appeared to Simon!"
- 35 *And they told what things were done in the way, and how he was known of them in breaking of bread.* The two told what had happened on the road, and how they had recognized Him in the breaking of the bread.
- 36 *And as they thus spake, Jesus himself stood in the midst of them, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you.* While they were still talking about these things, Jesus Himself stood among them and said to them, "Peace be to You."
- 37 *But they were terrified and affrighted, and supposed that they had seen a spirit.* They were startled and frightened, thinking they were seeing a ghost.

- 38 *And he said unto them, Why are ye troubled? and why do thoughts arise in your hearts?* He said to them, "Why are You troubled? Why do doubts arise in Your hearts?"
- 39 *Behold my hands and my feet, that it is I myself: handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as ye see me have.* "Look at My hands and My feet — it is I Myself. Touch Me and see, for a spirit does not have flesh and bones as You see I have."
- 40 *And when he had thus spoken, he shewed them his hands and his feet.* When He had said this, He showed them His hands and His feet.
- 41 *And while they yet believed not for joy, and wondered, he said unto them, Have ye here any meat?* While they still could not believe it for joy and were marveling, He said to them, "Have You anything here to eat?"
- 42 *And they gave him a piece of a broiled fish, and of an honeycomb.* They gave Him a piece of broiled fish and some honeycomb.
- 43 *And he took it, and did eat before them.* He took it and ate it in their presence.
- 44 *And he said unto them, These are the words which I spake unto you, while I was yet with you, that all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.* He said to them, "These are My words that I spoke to you while I was still with you — that everything written about Me in the Law of Moses, the Prophets, and the Psalms must be fulfilled."
- 45 *Then opened he their understanding, that they might understand the scriptures,* Then He opened their minds so they could understand the Scriptures.
- 46 *And said unto them, Thus it is written, and thus it behoved Christ to suffer, and to rise from the dead the third day:* He said to them, "This is what is written: the Christ must suffer and rise from the dead on the third day."
- 47 *And that repentance and remission of sins should be preached in his name among all nations, beginning at Jerusalem.* "Repentance and forgiveness of sins must be proclaimed in His name to all nations, beginning from Jerusalem."

48	<i>And ye are witnesses of these things.</i>	"You are witnesses of these things."
49	<i>And, behold, I send the promise of my Father upon you: but tarry ye in the city of Jerusalem, until ye be endued with power from on high.</i>	"I am sending the promise of My Father upon You. But wait in the city of Jerusalem until You are clothed with power from on high."
50	<i>And he led them out as far as to Bethany, and he lifted up his hands, and blessed them.</i>	He led them out as far as Bethany. He lifted up His hands and blessed them.
51	<i>And it came to pass, while he blessed them, he was parted from them, and carried up into heaven.</i>	While He was blessing them, He was parted from them and carried up into heaven.
52	<i>And they worshipped him, and returned to Jerusalem with great joy:</i>	They worshiped Him and returned to Jerusalem with great joy.
53	<i>And were continually in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.</i>	They were continually in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Cross-References:

v5 — Mark 16:5-6; Rev 1:18; Matt 28:3-5; Luke 1:12-13; Rev 2:8
v6 — Matt 17:22-23; Luke 9:22; Mark 8:31; Matt 28:6; Mark 10:33-34
v26 — 1 Pet 1:11; Acts 17:3; Zech 13:7; Isa 53:1-12; Heb 2:8-10
v27 — Isa 7:14; Luke 24:44; Deut 18:15; Isa 53:1-12; Jer 33:14-15
v32 — Luke 24:45; Jer 23:29; Heb 4:12; Ps 39:3; Jer 20:9
v36 — 2 Thess 3:16; Isa 57:18; Mark 16:14; John 20:19-23; Luke 10:5
v44 — Zech 12:10; Luke 24:26-27; Zech 9:9; Acts 13:33; Ps 110:1-7
v45 — Acts 16:14; 1 John 5:20; Ps 119:18; 2 Cor 3:14-18; Acts 26:18
v46 — Isa 53:2-12; Isa 50:6; Luke 24:44; Luke 24:26-27; Luke 24:7
v47 — Isa 49:6; Acts 5:31; Matt 28:19; Acts 2:38; Acts 20:21
v48 — Acts 2:32; Acts 1:8; Acts 5:32; Acts 13:31; Acts 10:41
v49 — Acts 1:8; Acts 1:4; Joel 2:28-32; John 14:26; Isa 32:15

John

Author: John the apostle, son of Zebedee — the "beloved disciple" who reclined next to Jesus at the Last Supper and stood at the cross. Early church testimony from Irenaeus onward consistently identifies him as the author.

Date written: c. AD 85–95, later than the other three Gospels, written from Ephesus near the end of John's life.

Written to: The church broadly, with a clearly stated evangelistic purpose: "that ye might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing ye might have life through his name" (20:31).

Setting: The other three Gospels are already in circulation. John writes a supplementary Gospel, omitting much they cover and adding material found nowhere else — the wedding at Cana, Nicodemus, the Samaritan woman, Lazarus, the Upper Room Discourse.

Where this sits historically: Composed late in the reign of Domitian (AD 81–96), a generation after Jerusalem's destruction in AD 70, when emperor-worship and incipient gnostic teaching threatened the churches of Asia Minor.

Contemporaries: John was the last surviving apostle, writing alongside his own epistles and Revelation, while Clement of Rome was preparing his letter to Corinth and Christians were facing Domitian's persecution.

Big themes:

- The deity of Christ — John opens at the eternal beginning ("In the beginning was the Word") and closes with Thomas's confession ("My Lord and my God"); the full divinity of Jesus is the book's first premise
- The seven "I AM" sayings — Bread of Life, Light of the World, Door, Good Shepherd, Resurrection and Life, Way/Truth/Life, True Vine; each echoes God's "I AM" to Moses
- The seven signs — water to wine, healing the nobleman's son, healing at Bethesda, feeding five thousand, walking on water, healing the blind man, raising Lazarus; each points to Jesus's identity
- The Holy Spirit as Comforter — chapters 14–16 contain the fullest NT teaching on the person and work of the Holy Spirit before Pentecost
- Life — the word "life" (Greek: ■) appears thirty-six times; John's Gospel is a book about eternal life and how to receive it

Key passages: John 1:1; 1:14; 3:16; 11:25–26; 14:6

How it fits: John's Gospel is both the simplest (a child can understand 3:16) and the most profound (theologians have never exhausted 1:1). It is the Gospel most quoted in evangelism and most studied in the academy. The prologue (1:1–18) is the NT's fullest statement of the pre-existent, incarnate Word.

Chapter 1

John declares that the eternal Word was with God and was God, and that through Him all things were made. The Word became flesh and dwelt among men. John the Baptist testifies that Jesus is the Lamb of God, and Jesus calls His first disciples — Andrew, Simon Peter, Philip, and Nathanael.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **The Word** (Greek: Logos) — In Greek thought, the Logos was the divine reason or principle that orders the universe. John takes this concept and fills it with the full weight of Hebrew revelation: the Word is not an idea — He is a Person. He is God's eternal self-expression, the one through whom all things were made. John's opening verse echoes Genesis 1:1 ("In the beginning") to show that Jesus existed before creation, was with the Father, and was Himself fully God. "The Word became flesh" (v. 14) is the miracle at the center of Christianity.

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| 1 | <i>In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.</i> | In the beginning was the Word. The Word was with God, and the Word was God. |
| 2 | <i>The same was in the beginning with God.</i> | He was with God in the beginning. |
| 3 | <i>All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.</i> | All things were made through Him. Nothing that has been made was made without Him. |
| 4 | <i>In him was life; and the life was the light of men.</i> | In Him was life, and that life was the light of men. |
| 5 | <i>And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.</i> | The light shines in darkness, and the darkness comprehended it not. |
| 6 | <i>There was a man sent from God, whose name was John.</i> | There was a man sent from God whose name was John. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **John** (the Baptist) (JON) — "the LORD is gracious" — A prophet sent by God to prepare the way for the Messiah. He preached repentance and baptized in the Jordan River. He is called "the Baptist" to distinguish him from John the apostle, the author of this Gospel.

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| 7 | <i>The same came for a witness, to bear witness of the Light, that all men through him might believe.</i> | He came as a witness to testify about the Light, so that all might believe through Him. |
| 8 | <i>He was not that Light, but was sent to bear witness of that Light.</i> | He was not the Light, but came to bear witness to the Light. |

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| 9 <i>That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world.</i> | The true Light, which gives light to every man, was coming into the world. |
| 10 <i>He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not.</i> | He was in the world. The world was made through Him, yet the world did not know Him. |
| 11 <i>He came unto his own, and his own received him not.</i> | He came to His own people, and His own people did not receive Him. |
| 12 <i>But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name:</i> | But to all who did receive Him — to those who believed in His name — He gave the right to become children of God. |
| 13 <i>Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God.</i> | These were born not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Only begotten** (OH-nlee bih-GOT-ten) — "the unique, one-of-a-kind Son." Christ is God's Son in a way that no one else can be. He was not created — He was eternally generated from the Father. When John says Jesus is the "only begotten Son," he is saying Jesus shares the very nature of God in a way that is completely unique. No other human, angel, or being can be called this.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve. It is not a reward for good behavior. It is God giving us what we need, not what we deserve. "Grace and truth came by Jesus Christ" means the full, free gift of God's favor arrived in the person of Jesus.

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| 14 <i>And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.</i> | The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw His glory — the glory of the only begotten of the Father — full of grace and truth. |
| 15 <i>John bare witness of him, and cried, saying, This was he of whom I spake, He that cometh after me is preferred before me: for he was before me.</i> | John testified about him and cried out, "This is the one I spoke of: He who comes after me ranks above me, because he was before me." |
| 16 <i>And of his fulness have all we received, and grace for grace.</i> | From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. |

- 17 *For the law was given by Moses, but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.* The law was given through Moses. Grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.
- 18 *No man hath seen God at any time; the only begotten Son, which is in the bosom of the Father, he hath declared him.* No one has ever seen God. The only begotten Son, who is in the Father's embrace, has made Him known.
- 19 *And this is the record of John, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, Who art thou?* This is John's testimony: when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask Him, "Who are You?"
- 20 *And he confessed, and denied not; but confessed, I am not the Christ.* He did not refuse to answer. He openly declared, "I am not the Christ."
- 21 *And they asked him, What then? Art thou Elias? And he saith, I am not. Art thou that prophet? And he answered, No.* They asked him, "What then? Are you Elijah?" He said, "I am not." "Are you the Prophet?" He answered, "No."
- 22 *Then said they unto him, Who art thou? that we may give an answer to them that sent us. What sayest thou of thyself?* Then they said, "Who are you? We need to give an answer to those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?"
- 23 *He said, I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Esaias.* He replied, "I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness: 'Make straight the way of the Lord,' as the prophet Isaiah said."
- 24 *And they which were sent were of the Pharisees.* Now those who were sent were from the Pharisees.
- 25 *And they asked him, and said unto him, Why baptizest thou then, if thou be not that Christ, nor Elias, neither that prophet?* They questioned Him further: "Then why do You baptize, if You are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?"
- 26 *John answered them, saying, I baptize with water: but there standeth one among you, whom ye know not;* John answered them, "I baptize with water. But there is one standing among You whom You do not know.

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| 27 <i>He it is, who coming after me is preferred before me, whose shoe's latchet I am not worthy to unloose.</i> | He is the one who comes after me, but ranks before me. I am not worthy to untie the strap of His sandal." |
| 28 <i>These things were done in Bethabara beyond Jordan, where John was baptizing.</i> | These things took place in Bethabara, beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing. |
| 29 <i>The next day John seeth Jesus coming unto him, and saith, Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world.</i> | The next day John saw Jesus coming toward Him and said, "Look — the Lamb of God, Who takes away the sin of the world! |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jesus** (JEE-zus) — Greek form of the Hebrew Yeshua, meaning "the LORD saves." The angel commanded this name before His birth (Matthew 1:21), because He would save His people from their sins. He is the central figure of all four Gospels and of all Scripture.

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| 30 <i>This is he of whom I said, After me cometh a man which is preferred before me: for he was before me.</i> | This is He of whom I said, 'After me comes a man who ranks before me, because he was before me.' |
| 31 <i>And I knew him not: but that he should be made manifest to Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water.</i> | I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was so that He might be revealed to Israel." |
| 32 <i>And John bare record, saying, I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove, and it abode upon him.</i> | Then John testified, "I saw the Spirit descend from heaven like a dove and remain on Him. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — The Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the older English word for "spirit" (from Old English *g■st*). The Holy Ghost is fully God — equal with the Father and the Son. He inspired the Scriptures, convicts the world of sin, and lives in every believer.

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| 33 <i>And I knew him not: but he that sent me to baptize with water, the same said unto me, Upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending, and remaining on him, the same is he which baptizeth with the Holy Ghost.</i> | I myself did not know Him, but He who sent me to baptize with water told me, 'The one on whom You see the Spirit descend and remain — He is the one who baptizes with the Holy Ghost.' |
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| 34 | <i>And I saw, and bare record that this is the Son of God.</i> | I have seen it and I testify that this is the Son of God." |
| 35 | <i>Again the next day after John stood, and two of his disciples;</i> | The next day John was standing there again with two of his disciples. |
| 36 | <i>And looking upon Jesus as he walked, he saith, Behold the Lamb of God!</i> | As He watched Jesus walk by, He said, "Look — the Lamb of God!" |
| 37 | <i>And the two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus.</i> | The two disciples heard Him say this and they followed Jesus. |
| 38 | <i>Then Jesus turned, and saw them following, and saith unto them, What seek ye? They said unto him, Rabbi, (which is to say, being interpreted, Master,) where dwellest thou?</i> | Jesus turned and saw them following and said to them, "What are You looking for?" They said to Him, "Rabbi" (which means Master), "where are You staying?" |
| 39 | <i>He saith unto them, Come and see. They came and saw where he dwelt, and abode with him that day: for it was about the tenth hour.</i> | He said to them, "Come and see." They came and saw where He was staying, and they stayed with Him that day. It was about the tenth hour. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Andrew** (AN-droo) — "manly" — A fisherman from Bethsaida, brother of Simon Peter. He was one of the first two disciples called by Jesus. Andrew is often seen bringing others to Jesus — first his brother Peter, and later the boy with loaves and fish (John 6:8–9).

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| 40 | <i>One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother.</i> | One of the two who heard John and followed Jesus was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother. |
| 41 | <i>He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messias, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.</i> | Andrew first found his own brother Simon and said to him, "We have found the Messiah" (which means the Christ). |
| 42 | <i>And he brought him to Jesus. And when Jesus beheld him, he said, Thou art Simon the son of Jona: thou shalt be called Cephas, which is by interpretation, A stone.</i> | He brought Him to Jesus. Jesus looked at Him and said, "You are Simon the son of Jona. You shall be called Cephas" (which means Peter, a rock). |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Philip** (FIL-ip) — "lover of horses" — A disciple of Jesus from Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter. Philip is notable in John's Gospel for his questions to Jesus (John 14:8) and for bringing Nathanael to Christ.

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| <p>43 <i>The day following Jesus would go forth into Galilee, and findeth Philip, and saith unto him, Follow me.</i></p> <p>44 <i>Now Philip was of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.</i></p> <p>45 <i>Philip findeth Nathanael, and saith unto him, We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.</i></p> | <p>The next day Jesus decided to go to Galilee. He found Philip and said to him, "Follow Me."</p> <p>Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.</p> <p>Philip found Nathanael and said to him, "We have found the one Moses wrote about in the Law, and the prophets also wrote about — Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nathanael** (nuh-THAN-ee-ul) — "God has given" — A disciple of Jesus, likely the same person as Bartholomew in the other Gospels. He is introduced as a man of honest character — Jesus calls him an Israelite in whom there is no deceit. His swift confession of Jesus as the Son of God shows his sincerity.

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| <p>46 <i>And Nathanael said unto him, Can there any good thing come out of Nazareth? Philip saith unto him, Come and see.</i></p> <p>47 <i>Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him, and saith of him, Behold an Israelite indeed, in whom is no guile!</i></p> <p>48 <i>Nathanael saith unto him, Whence knowest thou me? Jesus answered and said unto him, Before that Philip called thee, when thou wast under the fig tree, I saw thee.</i></p> <p>49 <i>Nathanael answered and saith unto him, Rabbi, thou art the Son of God; thou art the King of Israel.</i></p> | <p>Nathanael said to him, "Can anything good come out of Nazareth?" Philip said to him, "Come and see."</p> <p>Jesus saw Nathanael coming toward Him and said, "Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is no deceit!"</p> <p>Nathanael said to Him, "How do You know me?" Jesus answered, "Before Philip called you, when you were under the fig tree, I saw You."</p> <p>Nathanael answered Him, "Rabbi, You are the Son of God! You are the King of Israel!"</p> |
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- 50 *Jesus answered and said unto him, Because I said unto thee, I saw thee under the fig tree, believest thou? thou shalt see greater things than these.* Jesus answered, "Do You believe because I told You I saw You under the fig tree? You will see greater things than these."
- 51 *And he saith unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Hereafter ye shall see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of man.* He said to Him, "Truly, truly, I say to You, You will see heaven opened and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man."

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

only begotten — The unique, one-of-a-kind Son — Christ is God's Son in a way no one else can be; 'begotten' is not about birth but eternal relationship.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gen 1:1; John 17:5; Rev 19:13; Col 1:17; John 1:14
v3 — Col 1:16-17; 1 Cor 8:6; Rev 4:11; Ps 33:6; Gen 1:26
v4 — John 8:12; John 12:46; 1 John 1:5-7; John 5:26; John 9:5
v5 — John 3:19-20; John 12:36-40; 1 Cor 2:14; Job 24:13-17; John 1:10
v9 — John 12:46; John 1:4; 1 John 2:8; Isa 49:6; 1 Thess 5:4-7
v11 — Luke 19:14; Isa 53:2-3; John 3:32; Acts 7:51-52; Luke 20:13-15
v12 — Gal 3:26; Rom 8:14; 1 John 3:1; 2 Cor 6:17-18; Gal 4:6
v14 — 1 John 4:9; 1 Tim 3:16; Gal 4:4; John 1:1; Isa 40:5

v16 — Col 1:19; Rom 5:2; Eph 2:5-10; Eph 4:7-13; Col 2:9-10

v18 — Col 1:15; John 6:46; Matt 11:27; Luke 10:22; 1 John 4:12

v29 — Isa 53:7; 1 John 2:2; 1 John 3:5; 1 Pet 1:19; 2 Cor 5:21

v45 — Deut 18:18-22; Mic 5:2; Luke 24:27; Matt 2:23; Luke 24:44

Chapter 2

Jesus attends a wedding in Cana of Galilee and turns water into wine, His first miracle. He travels to Jerusalem for the Passover and drives the money changers out of the temple, declaring, 'Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.'

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| 1 <i>And the third day there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee; and the mother of Jesus was there:</i> | On the third day there was a wedding in Cana of Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there. |
| 2 <i>And both Jesus was called, and his disciples, to the marriage.</i> | Jesus and His disciples had also been invited to the wedding. |
| 3 <i>And when they wanted wine, the mother of Jesus saith unto him, They have no wine.</i> | When the wine ran out, the mother of Jesus said to Him, "They have no wine." |
| 4 <i>Jesus saith unto her, Woman, what have I to do with thee? mine hour is not yet come.</i> | Jesus said to her, "Woman, what does this have to do with Me? My hour has not yet come." |
| 5 <i>His mother saith unto the servants, Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it.</i> | His mother said to the servants, "Do whatever He tells You." |
| 6 <i>And there were set there six waterpots of stone, after the manner of the purifying of the Jews, containing two or three firkins apiece.</i> | Now there were six stone water jars there for the Jewish rites of purification, each holding twenty or thirty gallons. |
| 7 <i>Jesus saith unto them, Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim.</i> | Jesus said to them, "Fill the jars with water." They filled them to the brim. |
| 8 <i>And he saith unto them, Draw out now, and bear unto the governor of the feast. And they bare it.</i> | Then He said to them, "Now draw some out and take it to the master of the feast." They took it. |

- 9 *When the ruler of the feast had tasted the water that was made wine, and knew not whence it was: (but the servants which drew the water knew;) the governor of the feast called the bridegroom,* When the master of the feast tasted the water now turned into wine — not knowing where it had come from, though the servants who had drawn the water knew — he called the bridegroom
- 10 *And saith unto him, Every man at the beginning doth set forth good wine; and when men have well drunk, then that which is worse: but thou hast kept the good wine until now.* and said to Him, "Everyone serves the good wine first, and then the cheaper wine after people have had plenty. But You have kept the good wine until now."
- 11 *This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana of Galilee, and manifested forth his glory; and his disciples believed on him.* This was the first of Jesus's signs, done in Cana of Galilee. He revealed His glory, and His disciples believed in Him.
- 12 *After this he went down to Capernaum, he, and his mother, and his brethren, and his disciples: and they continued there not many days.* After this He went down to Capernaum with His mother, His brothers, and His disciples. They stayed there only a few days.
- 13 *And the Jews' passover was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem,* The Jews' Passover was near, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.
- 14 *And found in the temple those that sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the changers of money sitting:* In the temple He found those who were selling oxen and sheep and doves, and the money-changers sitting at their tables.
- 15 *And when he had made a scourge of small cords, he drove them all out of the temple, and the sheep, and the oxen; and poured out the changers' money, and overthrew the tables;* Making a whip of cords, He drove them all out of the temple — the sheep and the oxen as well. He poured out the money-changers' coins and overturned their tables.
- 16 *And said unto them that sold doves, Take these things hence; make not my Father's house an house of merchandise.* He said to those who sold doves, "Take these things away from here. Do not make My Father's house a house of trade."

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| 17 <i>And his disciples remembered that it was written, The zeal of thine house hath eaten me up.</i> | His disciples remembered that it is written, "Zeal for Your house will consume Me." |
| 18 <i>Then answered the Jews and said unto him, What sign shewest thou unto us, seeing that thou doest these things?</i> | The Jews then said to Him, "What sign can You show us for doing these things?" |
| 19 <i>Jesus answered and said unto them, Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.</i> | Jesus answered them, "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up." |
| 20 <i>Then said the Jews, Forty and six years was this temple in building, and wilt thou rear it up in three days?</i> | The Jews said, "This temple took forty-six years to build, and You will raise it up in three days?" |
| 21 <i>But he spake of the temple of his body.</i> | But He was speaking about the temple of His body. |
| 22 <i>When therefore he was risen from the dead, his disciples remembered that he had said this unto them; and they believed the scripture, and the word which Jesus had said.</i> | When He was raised from the dead, His disciples remembered that He had said this. They believed the Scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken. |
| 23 <i>Now when he was in Jerusalem at the passover, in the feast day, many believed in his name, when they saw the miracles which he did.</i> | While He was in Jerusalem at the Passover feast, many believed in His name when they saw the signs He was doing. |
| 24 <i>But Jesus did not commit himself unto them, because he knew all men,</i> | But Jesus did not entrust Himself to them, because He knew all people. |
| 25 <i>And needed not that any should testify of man: for he knew what was in man.</i> | He had no need for anyone to testify about man, for he himself knew what was in man. |

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Cross-References:

- v4 — John 7:6; John 7:30; John 13:1; John 8:20; John 12:23
- v5 — Gen 6:22; John 15:14; Heb 11:8; Luke 5:5-6; Heb 5:9
- v6 — John 3:25; Eph 5:26; Heb 9:10; Mark 7:2-5
- v11 — John 20:30-31; John 1:14; John 3:2; John 6:2; John 6:14
- v14 — Mark 11:15; Luke 19:45-46; Mark 11:17; Matt 21:12-13; Deut 14:23-26
- v16 — Matt 21:13; Jer 7:11; Mark 11:17; Isa 56:5-11; Luke 2:49
- v17 — Ps 69:9; Ps 119:139
- v19 — Mark 14:58; Mark 15:29; Matt 27:40; Matt 26:60-61; Matt 12:40
- v21 — 1 Cor 6:19; 1 Cor 3:16; Col 1:19; Heb 8:2; Eph 2:20-22
- v22 — John 12:16; Ps 16:10; John 16:4; John 14:26; Luke 24:7-8
- v24 — John 6:64; Matt 9:4; Acts 1:24; Heb 4:13; 1 Chr 28:9
- v25 — John 13:11; Matt 9:4; John 6:64

Chapter 3

Nicodemus, a Pharisee and ruler of the Jews, comes to Jesus by night, and Jesus tells him that a man must be born again to see the kingdom of God. Jesus declares that God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nicodemus** (nik-oh-DEE-mus) — "victory of the people" — A Pharisee and a ruler of the Jews who came to Jesus at night. He appears three times in John's Gospel (here, at 7:50, and at 19:39). His nighttime visit likely reflects both caution and genuine searching. His conversation with Jesus produced some of the most famous words in all of Scripture.

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| 1 | <i>There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews:</i> | There was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews. |
| 2 | <i>The same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God: for no man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him.</i> | He came to Jesus by night and said to Him, "Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher come from God, for no one can do these signs that you do unless God is with Him." |
| 3 | <i>Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.</i> | Jesus answered Him, "Truly, truly, I say to You, unless a man is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God." |

- 4 *Nicodemus saith unto him, How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born?* Nicodemus said to him, "How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter his mother's womb a second time and be born?"
- 5 *Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.* Jesus answered, "Truly, truly, I say to You, unless a man is born of water and of the Spirit, He cannot enter the kingdom of God.
- 6 *That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.* What is born of the flesh is flesh, and what is born of the Spirit is spirit.
- 7 *Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye must be born again.* Do not be amazed that I said to You, 'You must be born again.'
- 8 *The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.* The wind blows where it will. You hear its sound, but You do not know where it comes from or where it goes. That is how it is with everyone born of the Spirit."
- 9 *Nicodemus answered and said unto him, How can these things be?* Nicodemus said to him, "How can these things be?"
- 10 *Jesus answered and said unto him, Art thou a master of Israel, and knowest not these things?* Jesus answered, "You are a teacher of Israel and You do not understand these things?
- 11 *Verily, verily, I say unto thee, We speak that we do know, and testify that we have seen; and ye receive not our witness.* Truly, truly, I say to You, we speak of what we know and testify to what we have seen, but You do not receive our testimony.
- 12 *If I have told you earthly things, and ye believe not, how shall ye believe, if I tell you of heavenly things?* If I have told You earthly things and You do not believe, how will You believe if I tell You heavenly things?
- 13 *And no man hath ascended up to heaven, but he that came down from heaven, even the Son of man which is in heaven.* No one has ascended into heaven except he who descended from heaven — the Son of Man Who is in heaven.

- 14 *And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of man be lifted up:* Just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up,
- 15 *That whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have eternal life.* so that everyone who believes in Him may not perish but have eternal life.
- 16 *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.* For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, so that everyone who believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life.
- 17 *For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.* For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but so that the world might be saved through Him.
- 18 *He that believeth on him is not condemned: but he that believeth not is condemned already, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God.* Whoever believes in him is not condemned. But whoever does not believe is condemned already, because He has not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God.
- 19 *And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.* This is the judgment: the light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness rather than the light, because their deeds were evil.
- 20 *For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.* Everyone who does evil hates the light and does not come to the light, for fear that His deeds will be exposed.
- 21 *But he that doeth truth cometh to the light, that his deeds may be made manifest, that they are wrought in God.* But whoever does what is true comes to the light, so that it may be clearly seen that His deeds have been done in God.
- 22 *After these things came Jesus and his disciples into the land of Judaea; and there he tarried with them, and baptized.* After this Jesus and His disciples went into the land of Judaea. He stayed there with them and baptized.

- 23 *And John also was baptizing in Aenon near to Salim, because there was much water there: and they came, and were baptized.* John also was baptizing at Aenon near Salim, because water was plentiful there. People came and were baptized.
- 24 *For John was not yet cast into prison.* For John had not yet been thrown into prison.
- 25 *Then there arose a question between some of John's disciples and the Jews about purifying.* A dispute arose between some of John's disciples and a Jew about purification.
- 26 *And they came unto John, and said unto him, Rabbi, he that was with thee beyond Jordan, to whom thou barest witness, behold, he baptizeth, and all men come to him.* They came to John and said, "Rabbi, the one who was with you beyond the Jordan — the one You testified about — He is baptizing, and everyone is going to Him."
- 27 *John answered and said, A man can receive nothing, except it be given him from heaven.* John answered, "A man can receive nothing unless it is given to him from heaven.
- 28 *Ye yourselves bear me witness, that I said, I am not the Christ, but that I am sent before him.* You yourselves can testify that I said, 'I am not the Christ,' but that I have been sent before Him.
- 29 *He that hath the bride is the bridegroom: but the friend of the bridegroom, which standeth and heareth him, rejoiceth greatly because of the bridegroom's voice: this my joy therefore is fulfilled.* The one who has the bride is the bridegroom. The friend of the bridegroom, who stands and hears Him, greatly rejoices at the bridegroom's voice. This joy of mine is now complete.
- 30 *He must increase, but I must decrease.* He must increase, but I must decrease.
- 31 *He that cometh from above is above all: he that is of the earth is earthly, and speaketh of the earth: he that cometh from heaven is above all.* He who comes from above is above all. He who is of the earth is earthly and speaks of earthly things. He who comes from heaven is above all.

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| 32 | <i>And what he hath seen and heard, that he testifieth; and no man receiveth his testimony.</i> | He testifies to what He has seen and heard, yet no one receives his testimony. |
| 33 | <i>He that hath received his testimony hath set to his seal that God is true.</i> | Whoever receives his testimony has certified that God is true. |
| 34 | <i>For he whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God: for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him.</i> | He whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for God does not give the Spirit by measure to Him. |
| 35 | <i>The Father loveth the Son, and hath given all things into his hand.</i> | The Father loves the Son and has given all things into His hand. |
| 36 | <i>He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.</i> | Whoever believes in the Son has everlasting life. Whoever does not obey the Son shall not see life, but the wrath of God remains on Him. |

Words in this chapter:

Nicodemus (*nik-oh-DEE-mus*) — A Pharisee and member of the Sanhedrin who visited Jesus at night — Jesus told him 'you must be born again'; he later helped prepare Jesus's body for burial.

Jordan (*JOR-dan*) — The main river of Canaan — Israel crossed it miraculously to enter the Promised Land; Jesus was baptized in it by John.

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Cor 5:17; John 3:5-6; 1 Pet 1:23-25; 1 John 3:9; 1 John 5:1
- v5 — Ezek 36:25-27; Eph 5:26; Acts 2:38; 1 Pet 3:21; 1 Cor 6:11
- v6 — Gal 5:16-21; Ezek 36:26-27; Rom 8:4-9; 2 Cor 5:17; 1 Cor 15:47-50
- v8 — Eccl 11:4-5; 1 Cor 2:11; Acts 2:2; Ezek 37:9; 1 John 2:29
- v13 — Prov 30:4; John 6:38; Acts 2:34; John 1:18; John 13:3
- v14 — Num 21:7-9; John 8:28; John 12:32-34; Luke 24:26-27; Luke 24:44-46
- v16 — Rom 5:8; 1 John 4:9-10; Rom 8:32; John 3:15; John 11:25-26
- v17 — 1 John 4:14; Luke 19:10; John 12:47-48; John 6:57; John 6:40
- v18 — 1 John 5:10; Mark 16:16; Rom 8:1; John 5:24; 1 John 5:12
- v27 — Jas 1:17; 1 Cor 4:7; 1 Cor 15:10; 1 Pet 4:10-11; 1 Cor 2:12-14
- v30 — Col 1:18; Ps 72:17-19; Heb 3:2-6; Isa 9:7; 1 Cor 3:5
- v36 — John 5:24; John 1:12; 1 Thess 5:9; Eph 5:6; John 3:15-16

Chapter 4

Jesus speaks with a Samaritan woman at Jacob's well, revealing that He is the Messiah and offering her living water. Many Samaritans believe because of His words. He then heals a nobleman's son in Capernaum from a distance, His second sign.

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| 1 <i>When therefore the Lord knew how the Pharisees had heard that Jesus made and baptized more disciples than John,</i> | When the Lord learned that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus was making and baptizing more disciples than John |
| 2 <i>(Though Jesus himself baptized not, but his disciples,)</i> | (though Jesus Himself did not baptize, but His disciples did), |
| 3 <i>He left Judaea, and departed again into Galilee.</i> | He left Judaea and went back to Galilee. |
| 4 <i>And he must needs go through Samaria.</i> | He had to pass through Samaria. |
| 5 <i>Then cometh he to a city of Samaria, which is called Sychar, near to the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph.</i> | So He came to a city of Samaria called Sychar, near the field that Jacob had given to his son Joseph. |
| 6 <i>Now Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore, being wearied with his journey, sat thus on the well: and it was about the sixth hour.</i> | Jacob's well was there. Jesus, tired from the journey, sat down beside the well. It was about the sixth hour. |
| 7 <i>There cometh a woman of Samaria to draw water: Jesus saith unto her, Give me to drink.</i> | A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, "Give Me a drink." |
| 8 <i>(For his disciples were gone away unto the city to buy meat.)</i> | His disciples had gone into the city to buy food. |
| 9 <i>Then saith the woman of Samaria unto him, How is it that thou, being a Jew, askest drink of me, which am a woman of Samaria? for the Jews have no dealings with the Samaritans.</i> | The Samaritan woman said to Him, "How is it that You, a Jew, ask a drink of me, a woman of Samaria?" For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans. |

- 10 *Jesus answered and said unto her, If thou knewest the gift of God, and who it is that saith to thee, Give me to drink; thou wouldest have asked of him, and he would have given thee living water.* Jesus answered her, "If You knew the gift of God, and who it is that is saying to You, 'Give Me a drink,' you would have asked Him, and He would have given You living water."
- 11 *The woman saith unto him, Sir, thou hast nothing to draw with, and the well is deep: from whence then hast thou that living water?* The woman said to him, "Sir, you have no bucket, and the well is deep. Where do You get that living water?"
- 12 *Art thou greater than our father Jacob, which gave us the well, and drank thereof himself, and his children, and his cattle?* Are You greater than our father Jacob? He gave us the well and drank from it himself, along with his sons and his livestock."
- 13 *Jesus answered and said unto her, Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again:* Jesus answered her, "Everyone who drinks of this water will be thirsty again.
- 14 *But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst; but the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life.* But whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never be thirsty again. The water that I will give Him will become in Him a spring of water welling up to everlasting life."
- 15 *The woman saith unto him, Sir, give me this water, that I thirst not, neither come hither to draw.* The woman said to him, "Sir, give me this water, so that I will not be thirsty or have to come here to draw water."
- 16 *Jesus saith unto her, Go, call thy husband, and come hither.* Jesus said to her, "Go, call Your husband, and come back here."
- 17 *The woman answered and said, I have no husband. Jesus said unto her, Thou hast well said, I have no husband:* The woman answered him, "I have no husband." Jesus said to her, "You are right in saying, 'I have no husband.'
- 18 *For thou hast had five husbands; and he whom thou now hast is not thy husband: in that saidst thou truly.* You have had five husbands, and the man you now have is not your husband. You spoke the truth."

- 19 *The woman saith unto him, Sir, I perceive that thou art a prophet.* The woman said to him, "Sir, I see that you are a prophet.
- 20 *Our fathers worshipped in this mountain; and ye say, that in Jerusalem is the place where men ought to worship.* Our fathers worshipped on this mountain, but you Jews say that Jerusalem is the place where people ought to worship."
- 21 *Jesus saith unto her, Woman, believe me, the hour cometh, when ye shall neither in this mountain, nor yet at Jerusalem, worship the Father.* Jesus said to her, "Woman, believe Me, the hour is coming when You will worship the Father neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem.
- 22 *Ye worship ye know not what: we know what we worship: for salvation is of the Jews.* You worship what You do not know. We worship what we know, for salvation is from the Jews.
- 23 *But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him.* But the hour is coming — and is now here — when true worshippers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth. The Father is seeking such people to worship Him.
- 24 *God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.* God is Spirit, and those who worship Him must worship in spirit and in truth."
- 25 *The woman saith unto him, I know that Messias cometh, which is called Christ: when he is come, he will tell us all things.* The woman said to him, "I know that Messiah is coming (He who is called Christ). When He comes, He will tell us all things."
- 26 *Jesus saith unto her, I that speak unto thee am he.* Jesus said to her, "I who speak to You am He."
- 27 *And upon this came his disciples, and marvelled that he talked with the woman: yet no man said, What seekest thou? or, Why talkest thou with her?* Just then His disciples came back. They were surprised that He was talking with a woman, but no one said, "What are you seeking?" or "Why are you talking with her?"

- 28 *The woman then left her waterpot, and went her way into the city, and saith to the men,* The woman left her water jar and went back into the city. She said to the people,
- 29 *Come, see a man, which told me all things that ever I did: is not this the Christ?* "Come, see a man who told me everything I ever did. Could this be the Christ?"
- 30 *Then they went out of the city, and came unto him.* They left the city and came to Him.
- 31 *In the mean while his disciples prayed him, saying, Master, eat.* Meanwhile, His disciples urged Him, saying, "Rabbi, eat something."
- 32 *But he said unto them, I have meat to eat that ye know not of.* But He said to them, "I have food to eat that You do not know about."
- 33 *Therefore said the disciples one to another, Hath any man brought him ought to eat?* So the disciples said to one another, "Has anyone brought him something to eat?"
- 34 *Jesus saith unto them, My meat is to do the will of him that sent me, and to finish his work.* Jesus said to them, "My food is to do the will of Him who sent Me and to finish His work."
- 35 *Say not ye, There are yet four months, and then cometh harvest? behold, I say unto you, Lift up your eyes, and look on the fields; for they are white already to harvest.* Do You not say, 'There are yet four months, and then comes the harvest'? Look, I tell You — lift up Your eyes and see that the fields are already white for harvest.
- 36 *And he that reapeth receiveth wages, and gathereth fruit unto life eternal: that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together.* The reaper is already receiving His wages and gathering fruit for eternal life, so that the sower and reaper may rejoice together.
- 37 *And herein is that saying true, One soweth, and another reapeth.* For in this the saying holds true: 'One sows and another reaps.'
- 38 *I sent you to reap that whereon ye bestowed no labour: other men laboured, and ye are entered into their labours.* I sent You to reap what You did not work for. Others have worked, and You have entered into their labor."

- 39 *And many of the Samaritans of that city believed on him for the saying of the woman, which testified, He told me all that ever I did.* Many Samaritans from that city believed in Him because of the woman's testimony: "He told me everything I ever did."
- 40 *So when the Samaritans were come unto him, they besought him that he would tarry with them: and he abode there two days.* So when the Samaritans came to Him, they asked Him to stay with them. He stayed there two days.
- 41 *And many more believed because of his own word;* Many more believed because of His own word.
- 42 *And said unto the woman, Now we believe, not because of thy saying: for we have heard him ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Christ, the Saviour of the world.* They said to the woman, "We no longer believe just because of what you said. We have heard him ourselves, and we know that this is indeed the Christ, the Savior of the world."
- 43 *Now after two days he departed thence, and went into Galilee.* After the two days He departed from there for Galilee.
- 44 *For Jesus himself testified, that a prophet hath no honour in his own country.* For Jesus Himself had testified that a prophet has no honor in His own hometown.
- 45 *Then when he was come into Galilee, the Galilaeans received him, having seen all the things that he did at Jerusalem at the feast: for they also went unto the feast.* When He arrived in Galilee, the Galileans welcomed Him, having seen all the things He had done in Jerusalem at the feast — for they had also gone to the feast.
- 46 *So Jesus came again into Cana of Galilee, where he made the water wine. And there was a certain nobleman, whose son was sick at Capernaum.* Jesus came again to Cana in Galilee, where He had turned the water into wine. There was a royal official whose son was sick in Capernaum.

- 47 *When he heard that Jesus was come out of Judaea into Galilee, he went unto him, and besought him that he would come down, and heal his son: for he was at the point of death.* When this man heard that Jesus had come from Judaea to Galilee, He went to Him and begged Him to come down and heal His son, who was close to death.
- 48 *Then said Jesus unto him, Except ye see signs and wonders, ye will not believe.* Jesus said to Him, "Unless You see signs and wonders, You will not believe."
- 49 *The nobleman saith unto him, Sir, come down ere my child die.* The official said to Him, "Sir, come down before my child dies."
- 50 *Jesus saith unto him, Go thy way; thy son liveth. And the man believed the word that Jesus had spoken unto him, and he went his way.* Jesus said to Him, "Go. Your son will live." The man believed the word that Jesus had spoken to Him and went on His way.
- 51 *And as he was now going down, his servants met him, and told him, saying, Thy son liveth.* As He was on His way down, His servants met him and told him, "Your son is alive."
- 52 *Then enquired he of them the hour when he began to amend. And they said unto him, Yesterday at the seventh hour the fever left him.* He asked them the hour when He had begun to recover. They said to Him, "Yesterday at the seventh hour the fever left Him."
- 53 *So the father knew that it was at the same hour, in the which Jesus said unto him, Thy son liveth: and himself believed, and his whole house.* The father knew it was the same hour when Jesus had said to Him, "Your son will live." He Himself believed, and His whole household.
- 54 *This is again the second miracle that Jesus did, when he was come out of Judaea into Galilee.* This was the second sign Jesus did after coming from Judaea into Galilee.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Samaritans (*sah-MEHR-ih-tanz*) — People of mixed descent who lived in Samaria after the Assyrian conquest — Jews despised them as half-breeds who had corrupted their religion; Jesus's parable of the Good Samaritan shocked His audience.

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Josh 24:32; Gen 33:19; Gen 48:22
- v9 — Acts 10:28; 2 Kgs 17:24-41; Matt 10:5; John 8:48; Luke 17:16-19
- v10 — John 4:14; Rev 7:17; John 7:37-39; Isa 44:3; John 3:16
- v14 — John 7:38-39; John 6:35; Isa 49:10; Rev 7:16; Eph 1:13-14
- v22 — Acts 17:23; Rom 9:4-5; Isa 2:3; Luke 24:47; Acts 17:30
- v23 — Phil 3:3; Matt 15:7-9; John 5:25; Gal 4:6; Rom 8:26
- v24 — 2 Cor 3:17; Matt 15:8-9; Phil 3:3; Ps 51:17; Isa 57:15
- v32 — Job 23:12; Ps 119:103; John 4:34; Prov 18:20; Jer 15:16
- v34 — John 6:38; John 5:30; Job 23:12; John 17:4; John 19:30
- v35 — Luke 10:2-3; Matt 9:37-38
- v42 — 1 John 4:14; John 1:29; 1 John 5:20; 1 Tim 4:10; Acts 4:12
- v48 — John 20:29; Heb 2:4; 1 Cor 1:22; Dan 4:2; John 12:37

Chapter 5

Jesus heals a man who had been lame for thirty-eight years at the pool of Bethesda on the Sabbath. The Jews persecute Him for healing on the Sabbath, and Jesus declares that He does what He sees the Father doing, claiming equal authority with God to give life and execute judgment.

1	<i>After this there was a feast of the Jews; and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.</i>	After this there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.
2	<i>Now there is at Jerusalem by the sheep market a pool, which is called in the Hebrew tongue Bethesda, having five porches.</i>	Now there is in Jerusalem, by the Sheep Gate, a pool called Bethesda in Hebrew, which has five covered colonnades.
3	<i>In these lay a great multitude of impotent folk, of blind, halt, withered, waiting for the moving of the water.</i>	In these lay a great crowd of sick people — the blind, the lame, and the paralyzed — waiting for the moving of the water.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God's mercy means He withholds the wrath and judgment we have earned by our sin. Mercy and grace are related but distinct: grace gives us what we do not deserve; mercy holds back what we do deserve. Both flow freely from God toward those who trust in Him.

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| <p>4 <i>For an angel went down at a certain season into the pool, and troubled the water: whosoever then first after the troubling of the water stepped in was made whole of whatsoever disease he had.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And a certain man was there, which had an infirmity thirty and eight years.</i></p> <p>6 <i>When Jesus saw him lie, and knew that he had been now a long time in that case, he saith unto him, Wilt thou be made whole?</i></p> <p>7 <i>The impotent man answered him, Sir, I have no man, when the water is troubled, to put me into the pool: but while I am coming, another steppeth down before me.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Jesus saith unto him, Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked: and on the same day was the sabbath.</i></p> <p>10 <i>The Jews therefore said unto him that was cured, It is the sabbath day: it is not lawful for thee to carry thy bed.</i></p> <p>11 <i>He answered them, He that made me whole, the same said unto me, Take up thy bed, and walk.</i></p> | <p>For at certain times an angel went down into the pool and stirred the water. Whoever stepped in first after the water was stirred was healed of whatever disease He had.</p> <p>One man there had been ill for thirty-eight years.</p> <p>When Jesus saw Him lying there and knew that He had already been there a long time, He said to Him, "Do You want to be made well?"</p> <p>The sick man answered Him, "Sir, I have no one to put me into the pool when the water is stirred. While I am making my way, someone else steps in before me."</p> <p>Jesus said to Him, "Get up, pick up Your mat, and walk."</p> <p>Immediately the man was made well. He picked up his mat and walked. Now that day was the Sabbath.</p> <p>So the Jews said to the man who had been healed, "It is the Sabbath. It is not lawful for you to carry your mat."</p> <p>He answered them, "The man who made me well said to me, 'Pick up your mat and walk.'"</p> |
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- 12 *Then asked they him, What man is that which said unto thee, Take up thy bed, and walk?* They asked him, "Who is the man who said to you, 'Pick up your mat and walk'?"
- 13 *And he that was healed wist not who it was: for Jesus had conveyed himself away, a multitude being in that place.* The man who had been healed did not know who it was, for Jesus had slipped away into the crowd that was in the place.
- 14 *Afterward Jesus findeth him in the temple, and said unto him, Behold, thou art made whole: sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.* Afterward Jesus found Him in the temple and said to Him, "See — you are well! Sin no more, or something worse may happen to You."
- 15 *The man departed, and told the Jews that it was Jesus, which had made him whole.* The man went away and told the Jews that it was Jesus Who had made Him well.
- 16 *And therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day.* This was why the Jews were persecuting Jesus — because He was doing these things on the Sabbath.
- 17 *But Jesus answered them, My Father worketh hitherto, and I work.* But Jesus answered them, "My Father is working until now, and I am working."
- 18 *Therefore the Jews sought the more to kill him, because he not only had broken the sabbath, but said also that God was his Father, making himself equal with God.* This made the Jews all the more determined to kill Him — not only was He breaking the Sabbath, but He was calling God His own Father, making Himself equal with God.
- 19 *Then answered Jesus and said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, The Son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the Father do: for what things soever he doeth, these also doeth the Son likewise.* Jesus answered them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, the Son can do nothing on His own — only what He sees the Father doing. Whatever the Father does, the Son does likewise.

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| <p>20 <i>For the Father loveth the Son, and sheweth him all things that himself doeth: and he will shew him greater works than these, that ye may marvel.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.</i></p> | <p>For the Father loves the Son and shows Him everything He Himself does. He will show Him even greater works than these, so that You will be amazed.</p> <p>For just as the Father raises the dead and quickens them, so also the Son quickens whom He will.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Quickened** (KWIK-end) — *Made alive; spiritually brought from death to life by God. This word describes the miracle of salvation — a soul that was dead in sin is made alive by God's power. Jesus says here that He has this same power as the Father — to raise the dead and give life. This is one of the great claims to His deity.*

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| <p>22 <i>For the Father judgeth no man, but hath committed all judgment unto the Son:</i></p> <p>23 <i>That all men should honour the Son, even as they honour the Father. He that honoureth not the Son honoureth not the Father which hath sent him.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Verily, verily, I say unto you, The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live.</i></p> <p>26 <i>For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself;</i></p> <p>27 <i>And hath given him authority to execute judgment also, because he is the Son of man.</i></p> | <p>The Father judges no one, but has given all judgment to the Son,</p> <p>so that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. Whoever does not honor the Son does not honor the Father who sent Him.</p> <p>Truly, truly, I say to You, whoever hears My word and believes in him who sent Me has everlasting life. He does not come into condemnation but has passed from death to life.</p> <p>Truly, truly, I say to You, the hour is coming — and is now here — when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live.</p> <p>For as the Father has life in Himself, so He has granted the Son also to have life in Himself.</p> <p>He has given Him authority to execute judgment, because He is the Son of Man.</p> |
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- 28 *Marvel not at this: for the hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice,* Do not be amazed at this, for the hour is coming when all who are in the graves will hear His voice
- 29 *And shall come forth; they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation.* and will come out — those who have done good to the resurrection of life, and those who have done evil to the resurrection of damnation.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — *God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. When Jesus speaks of the "resurrection of damnation," He means the judgment that ends in eternal punishment. The word is strong on purpose. It is not merely "condemnation" in the legal sense — it is the final verdict that has permanent consequences. Scripture is clear that both destinies are real and eternal.*

- 30 *I can of mine own self do nothing: as I hear, I judge: and my judgment is just; because I seek not mine own will, but the will of the Father which hath sent me.* I can do nothing on My own. I judge as I hear, and My judgment is just — because I seek not My own will but the will of Him who sent Me.
- 31 *If I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true.* If I testify about Myself, My testimony is not true.
- 32 *There is another that beareth witness of me; and I know that the witness which he witnesseth of me is true.* There is another who testifies about Me, and I know that His testimony about Me is true.
- 33 *Ye sent unto John, and he bare witness unto the truth.* You sent to John, and he has testified to the truth.
- 34 *But I receive not testimony from man: but these things I say, that ye might be saved.* Not that I accept human testimony — but I say these things so that You may be saved.
- 35 *He was a burning and a shining light: and ye were willing for a season to rejoice in his light.* John was a burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a time in His light.

- 36 *But I have greater witness than that of John: for the works which the Father hath given me to finish, the same works that I do, bear witness of me, that the Father hath sent me.* But I have a testimony greater than John's. The works that the Father has given Me to accomplish — the very works that I am doing — bear witness about Me that the Father has sent Me.
- 37 *And the Father himself, which hath sent me, hath borne witness of me. Ye have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his shape.* The Father who sent Me has Himself testified about Me. You have never heard His voice or seen His form.
- 38 *And ye have not his word abiding in you: for whom he hath sent, him ye believe not.* You do not have His word living in You, for You do not believe the one He has sent.
- 39 *Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me.* You search the Scriptures because You think that in them You have eternal life. It is they that testify about Me,
- 40 *And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.* yet You refuse to come to Me so that You may have life.
- 41 *I receive not honour from men.* I do not receive glory from people.
- 42 *But I know you, that ye have not the love of God in you.* But I know You — you do not have the love of God within You.
- 43 *I am come in my Father's name, and ye receive me not: if another shall come in his own name, him ye will receive.* I have come in My Father's name, and You do not receive Me. If another comes in His own name, You will receive Him.
- 44 *How can ye believe, which receive honour one of another, and seek not the honour that cometh from God only?* How can You believe, when You receive glory from one another and do not seek the glory that comes from the only God?
- 45 *Do not think that I will accuse you to the Father: there is one that accuseth you, even Moses, in whom ye trust.* Do not think that I will accuse You to the Father. There is one who accuses You — Moses, on whom you have set your hope.
- 46 *For had ye believed Moses, ye would have believed me: for he wrote of me.* If you believed Moses, you would believe Me — for he wrote about Me.

- 47

But if ye believe not his writings, how shall ye believe my words?
- But if you do not believe his writings, how will you believe My words?"

Words in this chapter:

- damnation** — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.
- sabbath** (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v14** — John 8:11; Lev 26:23-24; Ps 118:18; Matt 12:45; Neh 9:28
- v17** — John 9:4; John 14:10; Col 1:16; 1 Cor 12:6; Heb 1:3
- v19** — John 12:49; John 8:28; John 14:10; John 10:18; John 5:28-30
- v22** — John 5:27; Acts 17:31; 2 Cor 5:10; Matt 28:18; Acts 10:42
- v23** — 1 John 2:23; Luke 10:16; Matt 11:27; 2 John 1:9; John 15:23-24
- v24** — John 3:36; John 6:40; 1 John 5:11-13; John 3:18; Rom 8:1
- v25** — John 5:28; Eph 5:14; Eph 2:5; John 4:23; John 8:47
- v28** — Rev 20:12; 1 Thess 4:14-17; Isa 26:19; John 11:24-25; Job 19:25-26
- v29** — Dan 12:2-3; Rom 2:6-10; Acts 24:15; Luke 14:14; Matt 25:31-46
- v30** — John 6:38; John 5:19; John 4:34; John 14:10; Matt 26:39
- v39** — Luke 24:27; Luke 24:44; 2 Pet 1:19-21; Acts 26:22-23; Prov 8:33-34
- v46** — Deut 18:15; Deut 18:18-19; John 1:45; Luke 24:27; Num 24:17-18

Chapter 6

Jesus feeds five thousand men with five barley loaves and two small fish, then walks on the sea to His disciples' boat. He declares, 'I am the bread of life,' and teaches that whoever eats His flesh and drinks His blood has eternal life. Many disciples leave Him, but Peter confesses, 'You have the words of eternal life.'

- 1

After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is the sea of Tiberias.

After these things Jesus crossed to the other side of the Sea of Galilee, also called the Sea of Tiberias.
- 2

And a great multitude followed him, because they saw his miracles which he did on them that were diseased.

A great crowd followed Him, because they saw the miracles He was doing on the sick.
- 3

And Jesus went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples.

Jesus went up on a mountain and sat down there with His disciples.
- 4

And the passover, a feast of the Jews, was nigh.

Now the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was near.

- 5 *When Jesus then lifted up his eyes, and saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?* When Jesus looked up and saw a large crowd coming toward him, he said to Philip, "Where shall we buy bread so that these people may eat?"
- 6 *And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do.* He said this to test Him, for He Himself knew what He was going to do.
- 7 *Philip answered him, Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may take a little.* Philip answered him, "Two hundred denarii worth of bread would not be enough for each one of them to get even a little."
- 8 *One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, saith unto him,* One of His disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, said to him,
- 9 *There is a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes: but what are they among so many?* "There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two small fish. But what are they for so many people?"
- 10 *And Jesus said, Make the men sit down. Now there was much grass in the place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.* Jesus said, "Have the people sit down." There was plenty of grass in the place. So the men sat down, about five thousand in number.
- 11 *And Jesus took the loaves; and when he had given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes as much as they would.* Jesus took the loaves, and when He had given thanks, He distributed them to those who were seated. He did the same with the fish, giving out as much as they wanted.
- 12 *When they were filled, he said unto his disciples, Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost.* When they had all eaten their fill, He said to His disciples, "Gather up the leftover pieces so that nothing is wasted."

- 13 *Therefore they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above unto them that had eaten.* So they gathered them up and filled twelve baskets with the pieces left over from the five barley loaves — what remained after everyone had eaten.
- 14 *Then those men, when they had seen the miracle that Jesus did, said, This is of a truth that prophet that should come into the world.* When the people saw the miracle Jesus had done, they said, "This is truly the Prophet who is to come into the world!"
- 15 *When Jesus therefore perceived that they would come and take him by force, to make him a king, he departed again into a mountain himself alone.* Jesus, knowing that they were about to come and take Him by force to make Him king, withdrew again to the mountain by Himself alone.
- 16 *And when even was now come, his disciples went down unto the sea,* When evening came, His disciples went down to the sea.
- 17 *And entered into a ship, and went over the sea toward Capernaum. And it was now dark, and Jesus was not come to them.* They got into a boat and started across the sea toward Capernaum. By now it was dark, and Jesus had not yet come to them.
- 18 *And the sea arose by reason of a great wind that blew.* The sea grew rough because a strong wind was blowing.
- 19 *So when they had rowed about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, they see Jesus walking on the sea, and drawing nigh unto the ship: and they were afraid.* When they had rowed about three or four miles, they saw Jesus walking on the sea and drawing near to the boat. They were frightened.
- 20 *But he saith unto them, It is I; be not afraid.* But He said to them, "It is I. Do not be afraid."
- 21 *Then they willingly received him into the ship: and immediately the ship was at the land whither they went.* Then they were glad to receive Him into the boat, and immediately the boat reached the land where they were going.

- 22 *The day following, when the people which stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was none other boat there, save that one whereinto his disciples were entered, and that Jesus went not with his disciples into the boat, but that his disciples were gone away alone;* The next day the crowd that had stayed on the other side of the sea saw that only one boat had been there, and that Jesus had not gotten into it with His disciples — His disciples had gone away alone.
- 23 *(Howbeit there came other boats from Tiberias nigh unto the place where they did eat bread, after that the Lord had given thanks:)* Other boats from Tiberias came near the place where they had eaten the bread after the Lord had given thanks.
- 24 *When the people therefore saw that Jesus was not there, neither his disciples, they also took shipping, and came to Capernaum, seeking for Jesus.* So when the crowd saw that Jesus was not there, nor His disciples, they got into the boats and went to Capernaum looking for Jesus.
- 25 *And when they had found him on the other side of the sea, they said unto him, Rabbi, when camest thou hither?* When they found Him on the other side of the sea, they said to Him, "Rabbi, when did You get here?"
- 26 *Jesus answered them and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Ye seek me, not because ye saw the miracles, but because ye did eat of the loaves, and were filled.* Jesus answered them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, You are looking for Me not because You saw miracles, but because You ate the loaves and were filled.
- 27 *Labour not for the meat which perisheth, but for that meat which endureth unto everlasting life, which the Son of man shall give unto you: for him hath God the Father sealed.* Do not work for the food that perishes, but for the food that endures to everlasting life — which the Son of Man will give You. For on Him God the Father has set His seal."
- 28 *Then said they unto him, What shall we do, that we might work the works of God?* They said to Him, "What must we do to be doing the works of God?"

- 29 *Jesus answered and said unto them, This is the work of God, that ye believe on him whom he hath sent.* Jesus answered them, "This is the work of God: that You believe in Him whom He has sent."
- 30 *They said therefore unto him, What sign shewest thou then, that we may see, and believe thee? what dost thou work?* So they said to Him, "Then what sign will You do, so that we may see it and believe You? What work will You perform?"
- 31 *Our fathers did eat manna in the desert; as it is written, He gave them bread from heaven to eat.* Our fathers ate manna in the wilderness. As it is written, 'He gave them bread from heaven to eat.'"
- 32 *Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Moses gave you not that bread from heaven; but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven.* Jesus said to them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, it was not Moses who gave you the bread from heaven. My Father gives You the true bread from heaven.
- 33 *For the bread of God is he which cometh down from heaven, and giveth life unto the world.* For the bread of God is He who comes down from heaven and gives life to the world."
- 34 *Then said they unto him, Lord, evermore give us this bread.* They said to Him, "Lord, give us this bread always."
- 35 *And Jesus said unto them, I am the bread of life: he that cometh to me shall never hunger; and he that believeth on me shall never thirst.* Jesus said to them, "I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to Me shall never hunger, and whoever believes in Me shall never thirst.
- 36 *But I said unto you, That ye also have seen me, and believe not.* But I told You that You have seen Me and still do not believe.
- 37 *All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.* All that the Father gives Me will come to Me, and whoever comes to Me I will never cast out.
- 38 *For I came down from heaven, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me.* For I have come down from heaven not to do My own will but the will of Him who sent Me.

- 39 *And this is the Father's will which hath sent me, that of all which he hath given me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.* This is the will of Him who sent Me: that I should lose none of all He has given Me, but raise them up at the last day.
- 40 *And this is the will of him that sent me, that every one which seeth the Son, and believeth on him, may have everlasting life: and I will raise him up at the last day.* For this is the will of My Father: that everyone who looks to the Son and believes in Him shall have everlasting life, and I will raise Him up at the last day."
- 41 *The Jews then murmured at him, because he said, I am the bread which came down from heaven.* The Jews grumbled about Him because He said, "I am the bread that came down from heaven."
- 42 *And they said, Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? how is it then that he saith, I came down from heaven?* They said, "Is this not Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How can he now say, 'I have come down from heaven'?"
- 43 *Jesus therefore answered and said unto them, Murmur not among yourselves.* Jesus answered them, "Stop grumbling among yourselves.
- 44 *No man can come to me, except the Father which hath sent me draw him: and I will raise him up at the last day.* No one can come to Me unless the Father who sent Me draws Him. And I will raise Him up at the last day.
- 45 *It is written in the prophets, And they shall be all taught of God. Every man therefore that hath heard, and hath learned of the Father, cometh unto me.* It is written in the Prophets: 'They shall all be taught by God.' Everyone who has heard and learned from the Father comes to Me.
- 46 *Not that any man hath seen the Father, save he which is of God, he hath seen the Father.* Not that anyone has seen the Father except the one who is from God — He has seen the Father.
- 47 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me hath everlasting life.* Truly, truly, I say to You, whoever believes in Me has everlasting life.
- 48 *I am that bread of life.* I am the bread of life.

- 49 *Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness, and are dead.* Your fathers ate manna in the wilderness, and they died.
- 50 *This is the bread which cometh down from heaven, that a man may eat thereof, and not die.* This is the bread that comes down from heaven, so that one may eat of it and not die.
- 51 *I am the living bread which came down from heaven: if any man eat of this bread, he shall live for ever: and the bread that I will give is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world.* I am the living bread that came down from heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever. The bread that I will give is My flesh, which I will give for the life of the world."
- 52 *The Jews therefore strove among themselves, saying, How can this man give us his flesh to eat?* The Jews then argued with one another, saying, "How can this man give us his flesh to eat?"
- 53 *Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you.* So Jesus said to them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, unless You eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink His blood, You have no life in You.
- 54 *Whoso eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, hath eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day.* Whoever eats My flesh and drinks My blood has eternal life, and I will raise Him up at the last day.
- 55 *For my flesh is meat indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.* For My flesh is true food, and My blood is true drink.
- 56 *He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him.* Whoever eats My flesh and drinks My blood abides in Me, and I in Him.
- 57 *As the living Father hath sent me, and I live by the Father: so he that eateth me, even he shall live by me.* As the living Father sent Me, and I live because of the Father, so whoever feeds on Me will also live because of Me.
- 58 *This is that bread which came down from heaven: not as your fathers did eat manna, and are dead: he that eateth of this bread shall live for ever.* This is the bread that came down from heaven — not like the bread the fathers ate and died. Whoever eats this bread will live forever."

- 59 *These things said he in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum.* He said these things while teaching in the synagogue at Capernaum.
- 60 *Many therefore of his disciples, when they had heard this, said, This is an hard saying; who can hear it?* When many of His disciples heard this, they said, "This is a hard saying. Who can accept it?"
- 61 *When Jesus knew in himself that his disciples murmured at it, he said unto them, Doth this offend you?* But Jesus, knowing in Himself that His disciples were grumbling about it, said to them, "Does this offend You?"
- 62 *What and if ye shall see the Son of man ascend up where he was before?* What if You were to see the Son of Man ascending to where He was before?
- 63 *It is the spirit that quickeneth; the flesh profiteth nothing: the words that I speak unto you, they are spirit, and they are life.* It is the Spirit Who quickens — the flesh is of no help at all. The words that I have spoken to You are spirit and they are life.
- 64 *But there are some of you that believe not. For Jesus knew from the beginning who they were that believed not, and who should betray him.* But there are some of You who do not believe." For Jesus knew from the beginning who those were who did not believe, and who it was that would betray Him.
- 65 *And he said, Therefore said I unto you, that no man can come unto me, except it were given unto him of my Father.* He said, "This is why I told You that no one can come to Me unless it is granted him by the Father."
- 66 *From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.* After this, many of His disciples turned back and no longer walked with Him.
- 67 *Then said Jesus unto the twelve, Will ye also go away?* So Jesus said to the twelve, "Do You want to go away as well?"
- 68 *Then Simon Peter answered him, Lord, to whom shall we go? thou hast the words of eternal life.* Simon Peter answered him, "Lord, to whom shall we go? You have the words of eternal life.

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| 69 | <i>And we believe and are sure that thou art that Christ, the Son of the living God.</i> | We have come to believe and to know that You are the Christ, the Son of the living God." |
| 70 | <i>Jesus answered them, Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?</i> | Jesus answered them, "Did I not choose You, the twelve? And yet one of You is a devil." |
| 71 | <i>He spake of Judas Iscariot the son of Simon: for he it was that should betray him, being one of the twelve.</i> | He spoke of Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon — for it was he who would betray him, though he was one of the twelve. |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Capernaum (*kah-PER-nah-um*) — A town on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee — Jesus's base of operations for His Galilean ministry; home of Peter; where many miracles were performed.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v27 — Col 3:2; Isa 55:2; John 6:54; 2 Tim 2:19; Matt 6:19
- v29 — 1 John 3:23; Acts 16:31; John 3:36; Heb 5:9; 1 John 5:1
- v35 — John 6:48-58; Isa 55:1-3; Rev 22:17; John 6:41; Isa 49:10
- v37 — Matt 11:28; John 6:39; John 17:24; John 10:28-29; John 17:2
- v38 — John 5:30; John 4:34; John 3:31; Phil 2:7-8; Ps 40:7-8
- v44 — John 6:65; Matt 11:25-27; John 6:39-40; Eph 2:4-10; John 12:32
- v45 — Isa 54:13; Jer 31:33-34; Heb 10:16; Heb 8:10-11; 1 Thess 4:9
- v53 — 1 John 5:12; Matt 26:26-28; John 6:55; John 6:47; John 15:4
- v63 — Heb 4:12; Gal 5:25; Ps 119:93; John 6:68; Ps 119:130
- v65 — John 6:44-45; John 6:37; John 3:27; John 10:26-27; Eph 2:8-9
- v66 — Luke 9:62; 1 John 2:19; Heb 10:38; John 6:60; John 8:31
- v68 — Ps 73:25; John 5:24; 1 John 5:11-13; Acts 4:12; Acts 5:20

Chapter 7

Jesus goes up to Jerusalem for the Feast of Tabernacles and teaches in the temple, dividing the crowds over whether He is the Christ. On the last day of the feast He cries out, 'If any man thirst, let him come to Me and drink.' The Pharisees send officers to arrest Him, but they return empty-handed.

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| 1 | <i>After these things Jesus walked in Galilee: for he would not walk in Jewry, because the Jews sought to kill him.</i> | After this, Jesus traveled through Galilee. He would not go through Judea because the Jews were seeking to kill Him. |
| 2 | <i>Now the Jews' feast of tabernacles was at hand.</i> | Now the Jews' Feast of Tabernacles was near. |
| 3 | <i>His brethren therefore said unto him, Depart hence, and go into Judaea, that thy disciples also may see the works that thou doest.</i> | His brothers said to Him, "Leave here and go to Judea so Your disciples there can see the works You are doing. |
| 4 | <i>For there is no man that doeth any thing in secret, and he himself seeketh to be known openly. If thou do these things, shew thyself to the world.</i> | No one does things in secret when he wants to be known openly. If You do these things, show Yourself to the world." |
| 5 | <i>For neither did his brethren believe in him.</i> | For not even His brothers believed in Him. |
| 6 | <i>Then Jesus said unto them, My time is not yet come: but your time is always ready.</i> | Jesus said to them, "My time has not yet come, but Your time is always ready. |
| 7 | <i>The world cannot hate you; but me it hateth, because I testify of it, that the works thereof are evil.</i> | The world cannot hate You, but it hates Me because I testify that its works are evil. |
| 8 | <i>Go ye up unto this feast: I go not up yet unto this feast; for my time is not yet full come.</i> | You go up to the feast. I am not going up to this feast yet, because My time has not yet fully come." |
| 9 | <i>When he had said these words unto them, he abode still in Galilee.</i> | After saying this, He stayed in Galilee. |

- 10 *But when his brethren were gone up, then went he also up unto the feast, not openly, but as it were in secret.* But after His brothers had gone up to the feast, then He also went up — not openly, but in private.
- 11 *Then the Jews sought him at the feast, and said, Where is he?* The Jews were looking for Him at the feast and said, "Where is He?"
- 12 *And there was much murmuring among the people concerning him: for some said, He is a good man: others said, Nay; but he deceiveth the people.* There was a lot of muttering about him among the crowd. Some said, "He is a good man." Others said, "No — He leads the people astray."
- 13 *Howbeit no man spake openly of him for fear of the Jews.* But no one spoke openly about him out of fear of the Jews.
- 14 *Now about the midst of the feast Jesus went up into the temple, and taught.* About the middle of the feast, Jesus went up into the temple and began teaching.
- 15 *And the Jews marvelled, saying, How knoweth this man letters, having never learned?* The Jews were amazed and said, "How does this man know so much, having never studied?"
- 16 *Jesus answered them, and said, My doctrine is not mine, but his that sent me.* Jesus answered them, "My teaching is not My own. It comes from Him who sent Me.
- 17 *If any man will do his will, he shall know of the doctrine, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself.* If anyone chooses to do God's will, He will know whether this teaching is from God or whether I speak on My own.
- 18 *He that speaketh of himself seeketh his own glory: but he that seeketh his glory that sent him, the same is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.* Whoever speaks on his own authority seeks his own glory. But whoever seeks the glory of him who sent him — that man is true, and there is no falsehood in him.
- 19 *Did not Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keepeth the law? Why go ye about to kill me?* Did Moses not give you the law? Yet none of you keeps the law. Why are you trying to kill Me?"

- 20 *The people answered and said, Thou hast a devil: who goeth about to kill thee?* The crowd answered, "You have a devil! Who is trying to kill You?"
- 21 *Jesus answered and said unto them, I have done one work, and ye all marvel.* Jesus answered them, "I did one work, and You are all amazed.
- 22 *Moses therefore gave unto you circumcision; (not because it is of Moses, but of the fathers;) and ye on the sabbath day circumcise a man.* Moses gave you circumcision — not that it came from Moses, but from the fathers — and you circumcise a man on the Sabbath.
- 23 *If a man on the sabbath day receive circumcision, that the law of Moses should not be broken; are ye angry at me, because I have made a man every whit whole on the sabbath day?* If a man receives circumcision on the Sabbath so the law of Moses will not be broken, why are you angry at Me for making a man completely well on the Sabbath?
- 24 *Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment.* Do not judge by outward appearances. Judge with right judgment."
- 25 *Then said some of them of Jerusalem, Is not this he, whom they seek to kill?* Some of the people of Jerusalem said, "Is this not the man they are trying to kill?"
- 26 *But, lo, he speaketh boldly, and they say nothing unto him. Do the rulers know indeed that this is the very Christ?* Here He is, speaking openly, and they say nothing to Him! Can it be that the rulers really know that this is the Christ?
- 27 *Howbeit we know this man whence he is: but when Christ cometh, no man knoweth whence he is.* Yet we know where this man is from. When the Christ comes, no one will know where he is from."
- 28 *Then cried Jesus in the temple as he taught, saying, Ye both know me, and ye know whence I am: and I am not come of myself, but he that sent me is true, whom ye know not.* Then Jesus cried out in the temple as He taught, "You know Me, and You know where I am from. But I have not come on My own. He who sent Me is true, and him you do not know.

- 29 *But I know him: for I am from him, and he hath sent me.* I know Him, for I am from Him, and He sent Me."
- 30 *Then they sought to take him: but no man laid hands on him, because his hour was not yet come.* Then they tried to arrest Him, but no one laid hands on him, because his hour had not yet come.
- 31 *And many of the people believed on him, and said, When Christ cometh, will he do more miracles than these which this man hath done?* Yet many in the crowd believed in Him. They said, "When the Christ comes, will He do more signs than this man has done?"
- 32 *The Pharisees heard that the people murmured such things concerning him; and the Pharisees and the chief priests sent officers to take him.* The Pharisees heard the crowd muttering these things about Him. The chief priests and Pharisees sent officers to arrest Him.
- 33 *Then said Jesus unto them, Yet a little while am I with you, and then I go unto him that sent me.* Jesus said, "I am with You only a little while longer, and then I go to Him who sent Me.
- 34 *Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come.* You will look for Me but will not find Me. Where I am, You cannot come."
- 35 *Then said the Jews among themselves, Whither will he go, that we shall not find him? will he go unto the dispersed among the Gentiles, and teach the Gentiles?* The Jews said to one another, "Where does He intend to go that we cannot find Him? Will He go to those scattered among the Greeks and teach the Greeks?"
- 36 *What manner of saying is this that he said, Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come?* What does He mean when He says, 'You will look for Me but will not find Me,' and 'Where I am, You cannot come'?"
- 37 *In the last day, that great day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried, saying, If any man thirst, let him come unto me, and drink.* On the last and greatest day of the feast, Jesus stood up and cried out, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink.

- 38 *He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.* Whoever believes in Me, as the Scripture has said, out of His belly will flow rivers of living water."
- 39 *(But this spake he of the Spirit, for the Holy Ghost was not yet given; because that Jesus was not yet glorified.)* He said this about the Spirit, for the Holy Ghost had not yet been given, because Jesus was not yet glorified.
- 40 *Many of the people therefore, when they heard this saying, said, Of a truth this is the Prophet.* When the people heard these words, some of them said, "This really is the Prophet."
- 41 *Others said, This is the Christ. But some said, Shall Christ come out of Galilee?* Others said, "This is the Christ." But others said, "Will the Christ come from Galilee?"
- 42 *Hath not the scripture said, That Christ cometh of the seed of David, and out of the town of Bethlehem, where David was?* Does the Scripture not say that the Christ comes from the offspring of David, and from Bethlehem, the village where David was?"
- 43 *So there was a division among the people because of him.* So there was a division among the people over him.
- 44 *And some of them would have taken him; but no man laid hands on him.* Some of them wanted to arrest Him, but no one laid hands on him.
- 45 *Then came the officers to the chief priests and Pharisees; and they said unto them, Why have ye not brought him?* The officers went back to the chief priests and Pharisees, who said to them, "Why did You not bring Him?"
- 46 *The officers answered, Never man spake like this man.* The officers answered, "No one ever spoke like this man!"
- 47 *Then answered them the Pharisees, Are ye also deceived?* The Pharisees answered them, "Have you also been deceived?"
- 48 *Have any of the rulers or of the Pharisees believed on him?* Has any of the rulers or of the Pharisees believed in Him?
- 49 *But this people who knoweth not the law are cursed.* But this crowd, who do not know the law — they are accursed."

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| 50 | <i>Nicodemus saith unto them, (he that came to Jesus by night, being one of them,)</i> | Nicodemus — the one who had come to Jesus before, and who was one of them — said to them, |
| 51 | <i>Doth our law judge any man, before it hear him, and know what he doeth?</i> | "Does our law judge a man without first hearing from him and finding out what He is doing?" |
| 52 | <i>They answered and said unto him, Art thou also of Galilee? Search, and look: for out of Galilee ariseth no prophet.</i> | They answered Him, "Are You from Galilee too? Look it up — no prophet arises from Galilee." |
| 53 | <i>And every man went unto his own house.</i> | Then everyone went to His own house. |

Words in this chapter:

Feast of Tabernacles — Also called the Feast of Booths — a seven-day harvest festival where Israel lived in temporary shelters, remembering the wilderness wandering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Bethlehem (*BETH-leh-hem*) — A town in Judah — birthplace of David and of Jesus; its name means 'house of bread'; Boaz and Ruth lived here.

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 5:16-18; John 4:3; Matt 21:38; John 7:19; Acts 10:38
- v6 — John 7:8; John 2:4; John 7:30; John 17:1; John 13:1
- v7 — John 15:18-19; John 3:19; Gal 4:16; Prov 9:7-8; Jas 4:4
- v16 — John 14:24; John 14:10; John 5:30; John 12:49-50; John 6:38-40
- v17 — John 8:31-32; John 8:43; Jer 31:33-34; John 8:47; Dan 12:10
- v18 — John 5:41; John 13:31-32; Phil 2:3-5; 1 Cor 10:31-33; John 12:28
- v24 — Isa 11:3-4; Jas 2:9; John 8:15; Prov 17:15; Prov 24:23
- v27 — Mic 5:2; John 7:41-42; John 9:29; John 6:42; Matt 13:54-57
- v37 — Isa 55:1; John 4:14; John 6:35; Isa 12:3; Rev 22:17
- v38 — John 4:14; Isa 44:3; Isa 58:11; Isa 12:3; John 4:10
- v39 — Acts 2:17; Joel 2:28; John 14:16-17; Acts 2:33; Acts 2:4
- v42 — Mic 5:2; Matt 2:5; Jer 23:5; Luke 2:4; Matt 1:1

Chapter 8

The scribes and Pharisees bring a woman caught in adultery to Jesus, and He tells them, 'He that is without sin among you, let him first cast a stone at her.' Jesus declares, 'I am the light of the world,' and tells the Jews that before Abraham was, 'I AM,' provoking them to take up stones against Him.

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| 1 | <i>Jesus went unto the mount of Olives.</i> | Jesus went to the Mount of Olives. |
| 2 | <i>And early in the morning he came again into the temple, and all the people came unto him; and he sat down, and taught them.</i> | Early in the morning He came again into the temple. All the people came to him, and he sat down and taught them. |
| 3 | <i>And the scribes and Pharisees brought unto him a woman taken in adultery; and when they had set her in the midst,</i> | The scribes and Pharisees brought a woman who had been caught in adultery. They placed her in front of everyone |
| 4 | <i>They say unto him, Master, this woman was taken in adultery, in the very act.</i> | and said to Him, "Master, this woman was caught in the very act of adultery. |
| 5 | <i>Now Moses in the law commanded us, that such should be stoned: but what sayest thou?</i> | Moses commanded us in the law to stone such women. What do You say?" |
| 6 | <i>This they said, tempting him, that they might have to accuse him. But Jesus stooped down, and with his finger wrote on the ground, as though he heard them not.</i> | They said this to trap Him, so they would have grounds to accuse Him. But Jesus bent down and wrote with His finger on the ground. |
| 7 | <i>So when they continued asking him, he lifted up himself, and said unto them, He that is without sin among you, let him first cast a stone at her.</i> | When they kept pressing Him, He stood up and said to them, "Let Him who is without sin among You be the first to throw a stone at her." |
| 8 | <i>And again he stooped down, and wrote on the ground.</i> | He bent down again and wrote on the ground. |

- 9 *And they which heard it, being convicted by their own conscience, went out one by one, beginning at the eldest, even unto the last: and Jesus was left alone, and the woman standing in the midst.* One by one, convicted by their own conscience, they went away — beginning with the oldest and ending with the last. Jesus was left alone with the woman standing before him.
- 10 *When Jesus had lifted up himself, and saw none but the woman, he said unto her, Woman, where are those thine accusers? hath no man condemned thee?* Jesus stood up and said to her, "Woman, where are Your accusers? Has no one condemned you?"
- 11 *She said, No man, Lord. And Jesus said unto her, Neither do I condemn thee: go, and sin no more.* She said, "No one, Lord." Jesus said to her, "Neither do I condemn You. Go, and sin no more."
- 12 *Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life.* Jesus spoke to them again, "I am the light of the world. Whoever follows Me will not walk in darkness but will have the light of life."
- 13 *The Pharisees therefore said unto him, Thou bearest record of thyself; thy record is not true.* The Pharisees said to Him, "You are testifying about Yourself. Your testimony is not true."
- 14 *Jesus answered and said unto them, Though I bear record of myself, yet my record is true: for I know whence I came, and whither I go; but ye cannot tell whence I come, and whither I go.* Jesus answered them, "Even if I testify about Myself, My testimony is true. I know where I came from and where I am going. But You do not know where I come from or where I am going."
- 15 *Ye judge after the flesh; I judge no man.* You judge by human standards. I judge no one.
- 16 *And yet if I judge, my judgment is true: for I am not alone, but I and the Father that sent me.* Yet even if I do judge, My judgment is true — for it is not I alone who judge, but I and the Father who sent Me.
- 17 *It is also written in your law, that the testimony of two men is true.* It is written in Your law that the testimony of two men is true.

- 18 *I am one that bear witness of myself, and the Father that sent me beareth witness of me.* I am one who testifies about Myself, and the Father who sent Me testifies about Me."
- 19 *Then said they unto him, Where is thy Father? Jesus answered, Ye neither know me, nor my Father: if ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also.* They said to Him, "Where is Your Father?" Jesus answered, "You know neither Me nor My Father. If You knew Me, You would know My Father also."
- 20 *These words spake Jesus in the treasury, as he taught in the temple: and no man laid hands on him; for his hour was not yet come.* He spoke these words in the treasury, while teaching in the temple. No one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come.
- 21 *Then said Jesus again unto them, I go my way, and ye shall seek me, and shall die in your sins: whither I go, ye cannot come.* Jesus said to them again, "I am going away. You will look for Me, and You will die in Your sin. Where I am going, You cannot come."
- 22 *Then said the Jews, Will he kill himself? because he saith, Whither I go, ye cannot come.* The Jews said, "Will He kill Himself? Is that what He means by saying, 'Where I am going, You cannot come'?"
- 23 *And he said unto them, Ye are from beneath; I am from above: ye are of this world; I am not of this world.* He said to them, "You are from below. I am from above. You are of this world. I am not of this world.
- 24 *I said therefore unto you, that ye shall die in your sins: for if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins.* That is why I told You that You will die in Your sins. For if You do not believe that I am He, You will die in Your sins."
- 25 *Then said they unto him, Who art thou? And Jesus saith unto them, Even the same that I said unto you from the beginning.* They said to Him, "Who are You?" Jesus answered, "Just what I have been telling You from the beginning.

- 26 *I have many things to say and to judge of you: but he that sent me is true; and I speak to the world those things which I have heard of him.* I have much to say about You and much to judge. But He who sent Me is true, and I tell the world what I have heard from Him."
- 27 *They understood not that he spake to them of the Father.* They did not understand that He was speaking to them about the Father.
- 28 *Then said Jesus unto them, When ye have lifted up the Son of man, then shall ye know that I am he, and that I do nothing of myself; but as my Father hath taught me, I speak these things.* So Jesus said to them, "When You have lifted up the Son of Man, then You will know that I am He, and that I do nothing on My own. I speak just what the Father has taught Me.
- 29 *And he that sent me is with me: the Father hath not left me alone; for I do always those things that please him.* He who sent Me is with Me. He has not left Me alone, for I always do what pleases Him."
- 30 *As he spake these words, many believed on him.* As He spoke these words, many believed in Him.
- 31 *Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed;* Jesus said to the Jews who had believed in Him, "If You continue in My word, You are truly My disciples.
- 32 *And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.* You will know the truth, and the truth will set You free."
- 33 *They answered him, We be Abraham's seed, and were never in bondage to any man: how sayest thou, Ye shall be made free?* They answered Him, "We are Abraham's descendants and have never been enslaved to anyone. How can you say, 'You will be made free?'"
- 34 *Jesus answered them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin.* Jesus answered them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, everyone who commits sin is a slave to sin.
- 35 *And the servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the Son abideth ever.* A slave does not remain in the house forever. The Son remains forever.
- 36 *If the Son therefore shall make you free, ye shall be free indeed.* So if the Son sets You free, You will be truly free.

- 37 *I know that ye are Abraham's seed; but ye seek to kill me, because my word hath no place in you.* I know that you are Abraham's descendants. Yet you seek to kill Me because My word finds no place in you.
- 38 *I speak that which I have seen with my Father: and ye do that which ye have seen with your father.* I speak of what I have seen with My Father, and you do what you have heard from your father."
- 39 *They answered and said unto him, Abraham is our father. Jesus saith unto them, If ye were Abraham's children, ye would do the works of Abraham.* They answered Him, "Abraham is our father." Jesus said to them, "If You were Abraham's children, you would do what Abraham did.
- 40 *But now ye seek to kill me, a man that hath told you the truth, which I have heard of God: this did not Abraham.* But now you seek to kill Me — a man who has told you the truth that I heard from God. Abraham did not do this.
- 41 *Ye do the deeds of your father. Then said they to him, We be not born of fornication; we have one Father, even God.* You are doing the works of your father." They said to Him, "We were not born of fornication. We have one Father — God Himself."
- 42 *Jesus said unto them, If God were your Father, ye would love me: for I proceeded forth and came from God; neither came I of myself, but he sent me.* Jesus said to them, "If God were Your Father, You would love Me. I came from God and I am here. I did not come on My own — He sent Me.
- 43 *Why do ye not understand my speech? even because ye cannot hear my word.* Why do You not understand what I say? It is because You cannot bear to hear My word.
- 44 *Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it.* You are of your father the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning and does not stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks his native language — for he is a liar and the father of lies.

- 45 *And because I tell you the truth, ye believe me not.* But because I tell the truth, you do not believe Me.
- 46 *Which of you convinceth me of sin? And if I say the truth, why do ye not believe me?* Which of you can charge Me with sin? If I tell the truth, why do you not believe Me?
- 47 *He that is of God heareth God's words: ye therefore hear them not, because ye are not of God.* Whoever is of God hears the words of God. The reason you do not hear them is that you are not of God."
- 48 *Then answered the Jews, and said unto him, Say we not well that thou art a Samaritan, and hast a devil?* The Jews answered Him, "Are we not right in saying that You are a Samaritan and have a devil?"
- 49 *Jesus answered, I have not a devil; but I honour my Father, and ye do dishonour me.* Jesus answered, "I do not have a devil. I honor My Father, and You dishonor Me.
- 50 *And I seek not mine own glory: there is one that seeketh and judgeth.* I am not seeking My own glory. There is One who seeks it and judges.
- 51 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, If a man keep my saying, he shall never see death.* Truly, truly, I say to You, if anyone keeps My word, he will never see death."
- 52 *Then said the Jews unto him, Now we know that thou hast a devil. Abraham is dead, and the prophets; and thou sayest, If a man keep my saying, he shall never taste of death.* The Jews said to Him, "Now we know You have a devil! Abraham died, and so did the prophets. Yet you say, 'If anyone keeps My word, he will never taste death.'
- 53 *Art thou greater than our father Abraham, which is dead? and the prophets are dead: whom makest thou thyself?* Are You greater than our father Abraham, who died? The prophets died too! Who do you make Yourself out to be?"
- 54 *Jesus answered, If I honour myself, my honour is nothing: it is my Father that honoureth me; of whom ye say, that he is your God:* Jesus answered, "If I glorify Myself, My glory is nothing. It is My Father who glorifies Me — He of whom You say, 'He is our God.'

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| <p>55 <i>Yet ye have not known him; but I know him: and if I should say, I know him not, I shall be a liar like unto you: but I know him, and keep his saying.</i></p> <p>56 <i>Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day: and he saw it, and was glad.</i></p> <p>57 <i>Then said the Jews unto him, Thou art not yet fifty years old, and hast thou seen Abraham?</i></p> <p>58 <i>Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Before Abraham was, I am.</i></p> <p>59 <i>Then took they up stones to cast at him: but Jesus hid himself, and went out of the temple, going through the midst of them, and so passed by.</i></p> | <p>Yet You have not known Him. But I know Him. If I were to say I do not know Him, I would be a liar like You. But I do know Him and I keep His word.</p> <p>Your father Abraham rejoiced at the thought of seeing My day. He saw it and was glad."</p> <p>The Jews said to Him, "You are not yet fifty years old, and have You seen Abraham?"</p> <p>Jesus said to them, "Truly, truly, I say to You, before Abraham was, I am."</p> <p>At this they picked up stones to throw at Him. But Jesus hid Himself and went out of the temple, passing through the middle of them and going away.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Cross-References:

v5 — Lev 20:10; Deut 22:21-24; Ezek 16:38-40; Matt 5:17; Matt 19:6-8
v11 — John 3:17; John 5:14; Isa 1:16-18; John 8:15; Luke 15:7
v12 — John 12:46; John 9:5; John 12:35; Matt 5:14; Job 33:28
v19 — John 16:3; John 8:54-55; John 14:6-9; 2 Cor 4:4-6; John 1:10
v31 — 2 John 1:9; John 15:4-9; 2 Tim 3:14; Jas 1:25; 1 Tim 4:16
v32 — Rom 8:2; John 8:36; John 17:17; 1 Pet 2:16; John 14:6
v34 — Rom 6:16; 2 Pet 2:19; Prov 5:22; 1 John 3:8-10; Rom 6:12
v36 — 2 Cor 3:17; Gal 5:1; Rom 8:2; John 8:31-32; Luke 4:18
v42 — John 12:49; John 14:10; John 17:8; John 17:25; John 15:23-24
v44 — Acts 13:10; 1 John 3:12; 1 John 3:8-10; 2 Cor 11:3; Rev 12:9
v51 — John 11:25-26; John 5:24; John 3:15-16; John 6:50; John 15:20
v58 — Ex 3:14; Col 1:17; John 17:5; John 1:1-2; Isa 44:6

Chapter 9

Jesus heals a man born blind by anointing his eyes with clay and sending him to wash in the pool of Siloam. The Pharisees interrogate the man and his parents, refusing to accept the miracle, and cast him out of the synagogue. Jesus finds him and reveals Himself as the Son of God.

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| 1 | <i>And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.</i> | As Jesus walked along, He saw a man who had been blind from birth. |
| 2 | <i>And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?</i> | His disciples asked Him, "Master, who sinned — this man or his parents — that he was born blind?" |
| 3 | <i>Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.</i> | Jesus answered, "Neither this man nor his parents sinned. He was born blind so that the works of God might be displayed in Him. |
| 4 | <i>I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work.</i> | I must do the works of Him who sent Me while it is still day. Night is coming, when no one can work. |
| 5 | <i>As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.</i> | As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world." |
| 6 | <i>When he had thus spoken, he spat on the ground, and made clay of the spittle, and he anointed the eyes of the blind man with the clay,</i> | After saying this, He spat on the ground and made mud with the saliva. He spread the mud on the man's eyes |
| 7 | <i>And said unto him, Go, wash in the pool of Siloam, (which is by interpretation, Sent.) He went his way therefore, and washed, and came seeing.</i> | He said to him, "Go, wash in the pool of Siloam" (which means Sent). So the man went and washed, and came back seeing. |
| 8 | <i>The neighbours therefore, and they which before had seen him that he was blind, said, Is not this he that sat and begged?</i> | His neighbors and those who had seen him before as a beggar asked, "Is this not the man who used to sit and beg?" |

- 9 *Some said, This is he: others said, He is like him: but he said, I am he.* Some said, "It is him." Others said, "No, he just looks like him." But the man himself said, "I am the one."
- 10 *Therefore said they unto him, How were thine eyes opened?* So they asked him, "How were your eyes opened?"
- 11 *He answered and said, A man that is called Jesus made clay, and anointed mine eyes, and said unto me, Go to the pool of Siloam, and wash: and I went and washed, and I received sight.* He answered, "A man called Jesus made mud and spread it on my eyes. He told me to go to Siloam and wash. I went and washed, and I received my sight."
- 12 *Then said they unto him, Where is he? He said, I know not.* They asked Him, "Where is He?" He said, "I don't know."
- 13 *They brought to the Pharisees him that aforetime was blind.* They brought the man who had been blind to the Pharisees.
- 14 *And it was the sabbath day when Jesus made the clay, and opened his eyes.* Now it was the Sabbath day when Jesus had made the mud and opened His eyes.
- 15 *Then again the Pharisees also asked him how he had received his sight. He said unto them, He put clay upon mine eyes, and I washed, and do see.* The Pharisees asked Him again how He had received His sight. He said to them, "He put mud on my eyes, I washed, and now I see."
- 16 *Therefore said some of the Pharisees, This man is not of God, because he keepeth not the sabbath day. Others said, How can a man that is a sinner do such miracles? And there was a division among them.* Some of the Pharisees said, "This man is not from God, because He does not keep the Sabbath." Others said, "How can a sinful man do such signs?" And there was a division among them.
- 17 *They say unto the blind man again, What sayest thou of him, that he hath opened thine eyes? He said, He is a prophet.* They asked the blind man again, "What do you say about Him, since He opened your eyes?" He said, "He is a prophet."

- 18 *But the Jews did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind, and received his sight, until they called the parents of him that had received his sight.* The Jews did not believe that he had been blind and received his sight, until they called the parents of the man who had received his sight.
- 19 *And they asked them, saying, Is this your son, who ye say was born blind? how then doth he now see?* They asked his parents, "Is this your son, who you say was born blind? How does he now see?"
- 20 *His parents answered them and said, We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind:* His parents answered, "We know that this is our son and that he was born blind.
- 21 *But by what means he now seeth, we know not; or who hath opened his eyes, we know not: he is of age; ask him, he shall speak for himself.* But how he now sees, we do not know. We do not know who opened his eyes. He is of age — ask him. He can speak for himself."
- 22 *These words spake his parents, because they feared the Jews: for the Jews had agreed already, that if any man did confess that he was Christ, he should be put out of the synagogue.* His parents said this because they feared the Jews, for the Jews had already agreed that if anyone confessed Jesus to be the Christ, He would be put out of the synagogue.
- 23 *Therefore said his parents, He is of age; ask him.* That is why His parents said, "He is of age — ask Him."
- 24 *Then again called they the man that was blind, and said unto him, Give God the praise: we know that this man is a sinner.* So they called the man who had been blind a second time and said to him, "Give glory to God. We know that this man is a sinner."
- 25 *He answered and said, Whether he be a sinner or no, I know not: one thing I know, that, whereas I was blind, now I see.* He answered, "Whether He is a sinner, I don't know. One thing I know — I was blind, and now I see."
- 26 *Then said they to him again, What did he to thee? how opened he thine eyes?* They asked him again, "What did He do to you? How did He open your eyes?"

- 27 *He answered them, I have told you already, and ye did not hear: wherefore would ye hear it again? will ye also be his disciples?* He answered them, "I already told you, and you did not listen. Why do you want to hear it again? Do you also want to become His disciples?"
- 28 *Then they reviled him, and said, Thou art his disciple; but we are Moses' disciples.* Then they insulted him and said, "You are His disciple. We are disciples of Moses.
- 29 *We know that God spake unto Moses: as for this fellow, we know not from whence he is.* We know that God spoke to Moses. As for this man, we do not know where he comes from."
- 30 *The man answered and said unto them, Why herein is a marvellous thing, that ye know not from whence he is, and yet he hath opened mine eyes.* The man answered them, "This is remarkable — you do not know where He comes from, yet He opened my eyes.
- 31 *Now we know that God heareth not sinners: but if any man be a worshipper of God, and doeth his will, him he heareth.* We know that God does not listen to sinners. But if anyone worships God and does His will, God listens to Him.
- 32 *Since the world began was it not heard that any man opened the eyes of one that was born blind.* Never since the world began has anyone opened the eyes of a man born blind.
- 33 *If this man were not of God, he could do nothing.* If this man were not from God, He could do nothing."
- 34 *They answered and said unto him, Thou wast altogether born in sins, and dost thou teach us? And they cast him out.* They answered him, "You were born entirely in sin, and are you teaching us?" And they threw him out.
- 35 *Jesus heard that they had cast him out; and when he had found him, he said unto him, Dost thou believe on the Son of God?* Jesus heard that they had thrown Him out. When He found Him, He said, "Do You believe in the Son of God?"
- 36 *He answered and said, Who is he, Lord, that I might believe on him?* He answered, "Who is He, Lord, that I may believe in Him?"

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| 37 | <i>And Jesus said unto him, Thou hast both seen him, and it is he that talketh with thee.</i> | Jesus said to Him, "You have seen Him. It is He who is speaking with you now." |
| 38 | <i>And he said, Lord, I believe. And he worshipped him.</i> | He said, "Lord, I believe." And He worshipped Him. |
| 39 | <i>And Jesus said, For judgment I am come into this world, that they which see not might see; and that they which see might be made blind.</i> | Jesus said, "I came into this world for judgment — so that those who do not see may see, and those who do see may become blind." |
| 40 | <i>And some of the Pharisees which were with him heard these words, and said unto him, Are we blind also?</i> | Some of the Pharisees who were with Him heard this and said to Him, "Are we blind also?" |
| 41 | <i>Jesus said unto them, If ye were blind, ye should have no sin: but now ye say, We see; therefore your sin remaineth.</i> | Jesus said to them, "If You were blind, You would have no sin. But now You say, 'We see.' Therefore Your sin remains." |

Words in this chapter:

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Luke 13:2; John 9:34
- v3 — John 11:4; John 11:40; Eccl 9:1-2
- v4 — John 12:35; Eph 5:16; John 4:34; Eccl 9:10; John 11:9-10
- v5 — John 8:12; John 12:46; Acts 13:47; John 1:4-9; Acts 26:18
- v6 — Mark 7:33; Mark 8:23
- v7 — Isa 35:5; John 11:37; John 9:11
- v16 — John 10:19; John 7:43
- v22 — John 16:2; John 7:13; Luke 6:22
- v25 — 1 John 5:10; John 9:30; John 5:11
- v31 — Prov 15:29; Isa 1:15; Prov 28:9; Mic 3:4; Ps 145:19
- v39 — John 3:19; John 12:46; Acts 26:18; John 8:12; Luke 4:18
- v41 — Isa 5:21; John 15:22-24; 1 John 1:8-10; Luke 18:14; Prov 26:12

Chapter 10

Jesus declares, 'I am the good shepherd' who lays down His life for the sheep, and 'I am the door' by which the sheep enter. He teaches that He and the Father are one, and the Jews take up stones to kill Him for blasphemy. He withdraws beyond the Jordan, where many believe in Him.

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| 1 | <i>Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold, but climbeth up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber.</i> | "Truly, truly, I tell You — whoever does not enter the sheepfold by the door but climbs in by another way is a thief and a robber. |
| 2 | <i>But he that entereth in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.</i> | But whoever enters by the door is the shepherd of the sheep. |
| 3 | <i>To him the porter openeth; and the sheep hear his voice: and he calleth his own sheep by name, and leadeth them out.</i> | The gatekeeper opens for Him. The sheep hear His voice. He calls His own sheep by name and leads them out. |
| 4 | <i>And when he putteth forth his own sheep, he goeth before them, and the sheep follow him: for they know his voice.</i> | When He has brought out all His own, He goes before them, and the sheep follow Him because they know His voice. |
| 5 | <i>And a stranger will they not follow, but will flee from him: for they know not the voice of strangers.</i> | They will not follow a stranger. They will run from Him, because they do not know the voice of strangers." |
| 6 | <i>This parable spake Jesus unto them: but they understood not what things they were which he spake unto them.</i> | Jesus spoke this parable to them, but they did not understand what He was saying to them. |
| 7 | <i>Then said Jesus unto them again, Verily, verily, I say unto you, I am the door of the sheep.</i> | So Jesus said to them again, "Truly, truly, I tell You — I am the door of the sheep. |
| 8 | <i>All that ever came before me are thieves and robbers: but the sheep did not hear them.</i> | All who came before Me are thieves and robbers. The sheep did not listen to them. |
| 9 | <i>I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved, and shall go in and out, and find pasture.</i> | I am the door. Whoever enters through Me will be saved. He will come in and go out and find pasture. |

- 10 *The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.* The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I came that they may have life — and have it in full measure.
- 11 *I am the good shepherd: the good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep.* I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd gives His life for the sheep.
- 12 *But he that is an hireling, and not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming, and leaveth the sheep, and fleeth: and the wolf catcheth them, and scattereth the sheep.* The hired hand is not the shepherd. The sheep are not His own. When He sees the wolf coming, He abandons the sheep and runs. The wolf catches them and scatters the flock.
- 13 *The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep.* He runs because He is a hired hand and does not care about the sheep.
- 14 *I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine.* I am the good shepherd. I know My sheep and My sheep know Me.
- 15 *As the Father knoweth me, even so know I the Father: and I lay down my life for the sheep.* Just as the Father knows Me and I know the Father — I lay down My life for the sheep.
- 16 *And other sheep I have, which are not of this fold: them also I must bring, and they shall hear my voice; and there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.* I have other sheep that are not of this fold. I must bring them also. They will hear My voice, and there will be one flock and one shepherd.
- 17 *Therefore doth my Father love me, because I lay down my life, that I might take it again.* The Father loves Me because I lay down My life so that I may take it up again.
- 18 *No man taketh it from me, but I lay it down of myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. This commandment have I received of my Father.* No one takes it from Me. I lay it down of My own will. I have authority to lay it down, and I have authority to take it up again. This command I received from My Father."
- 19 *There was a division therefore again among the Jews for these sayings.* There was again a division among the Jews because of these words.

- 20 *And many of them said, He hath a devil, and is mad; why hear ye him?* Many of them said, "He has a devil and is out of His mind. Why listen to Him?"
- 21 *Others said, These are not the words of him that hath a devil. Can a devil open the eyes of the blind?* Others said, "These are not the words of someone possessed by a devil. Can a devil open the eyes of the blind?"
- 22 *And it was at Jerusalem the feast of the dedication, and it was winter.* The Feast of Dedication came, and it was winter in Jerusalem.
- 23 *And Jesus walked in the temple in Solomon's porch.* Jesus was walking in the temple in Solomon's Porch.
- 24 *Then came the Jews round about him, and said unto him, How long dost thou make us to doubt? If thou be the Christ, tell us plainly.* The Jews gathered around Him and said, "How long will You keep us in suspense? If You are the Christ, tell us plainly."
- 25 *Jesus answered them, I told you, and ye believed not: the works that I do in my Father's name, they bear witness of me.* Jesus answered them, "I told You, and You do not believe. The works I do in My Father's name — they testify about Me.
- 26 *But ye believe not, because ye are not of my sheep, as I said unto you.* But You do not believe, because You are not among My sheep — as I said to You.
- 27 *My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me:* My sheep hear My voice. I know them, and they follow Me.
- 28 *And I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my hand.* I give them eternal life. They will never perish, and no one will snatch them out of My hand.
- 29 *My Father, which gave them me, is greater than all; and no man is able to pluck them out of my Father's hand.* My Father, who has given them to Me, is greater than all. No one is able to snatch them out of My Father's hand.
- 30 *I and my Father are one.* I and the Father are one."
- 31 *Then the Jews took up stones again to stone him.* The Jews picked up stones again to stone Him.

- 32 *Jesus answered them, Many good works have I shewed you from my Father; for which of those works do ye stone me?* Jesus answered them, "I have shown You many good works from My Father. For which of those works are You stoning Me?"
- 33 *The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God.* The Jews answered Him, "We are not stoning You for a good work, but for blasphemy — because You, being a man, make yourself God."
- 34 *Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?* Jesus answered them, "Is it not written in Your law, 'I said, You are gods'?"
- 35 *If he called them gods, unto whom the word of God came, and the scripture cannot be broken;* He called them gods — those to whom the word of God came — and Scripture cannot be broken.
- 36 *Say ye of him, whom the Father hath sanctified, and sent into the world, Thou blasphemest; because I said, I am the Son of God?* Do You say of the one whom the Father set apart and sent into the world, 'You are blaspheming,' because I said, 'I am the Son of God'?
- 37 *If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not.* If I am not doing the works of My Father, do not believe Me.
- 38 *But if I do, though ye believe not me, believe the works: that ye may know, and believe, that the Father is in me, and I in him.* But if I am, even if You do not believe Me, believe the works — so that You may know and understand that the Father is in Me and I am in the Father."
- 39 *Therefore they sought again to take him: but he escaped out of their hand,* So they tried again to seize Him, but He escaped from their hands.
- 40 *And went away again beyond Jordan into the place where John at first baptized; and there he abode.* He went away again across the Jordan to the place where John had first baptized, and he stayed there.
- 41 *And many resorted unto him, and said, John did no miracle: but all things that John spake of this man were true.* Many people came to Him and said, "John performed no sign, but everything John said about this man was true."
- 42 *And many believed on him there.* And many believed in Him there.

Words in this chapter:

Solomon (*SOL-oh-mon*) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (*shalom*).

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 7:15; 1 John 4:1; John 10:8-10; Rom 16:18; Heb 5:4
- v7 — John 14:6; Eph 2:18; John 10:1; John 10:9; Ezek 34:31
- v9 — John 14:6; Eph 2:18; John 10:7; John 10:1; Rom 5:1-2
- v10 — Luke 19:10; John 6:51; John 12:47; John 3:17; John 6:33
- v11 — Ps 23:1; John 10:14-15; John 15:13; Rev 7:17; Isa 40:11
- v14 — John 10:27; 2 Tim 2:19; John 10:11; Eph 1:17; 1 John 5:20
- v16 — Isa 56:8; John 11:52; 1 Pet 2:25; Ezek 34:23; Eph 2:13-18
- v18 — Heb 2:9; Titus 2:14; John 10:17; John 2:19-21; John 14:31
- v27 — John 10:16; John 10:14; Rev 3:20; 1 Cor 8:3; John 10:3-4
- v28 — John 6:39-40; John 6:37; John 3:15-16; Heb 7:25; Rom 8:29
- v30 — John 1:1-2; John 14:9; John 17:21-23; John 5:23; John 8:58
- v34 — Ps 82:6-7; Ex 7:1; Ps 82:1; Ex 4:16; Ps 138:1

Chapter 11

Jesus raises Lazarus from the dead after four days in the tomb, weeping at the grave before commanding, 'Lazarus, come forth.' Many Jews believe in Him because of this sign. The chief priests and Pharisees, alarmed by the growing crowds, plot to put Jesus to death, and Caiaphas prophesies that Jesus would die for the nation.

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Now a certain man was sick, named Lazarus, of Bethany, the town of Mary and her sister Martha.
- Now a certain man was sick — Lazarus of Bethany, the village of Mary and her sister Martha.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lazarus** (*LAZ-uh-rus*) — Greek form of the Hebrew Eleazar, meaning "God is my help." He was a close friend of Jesus and the brother of Mary and Martha. His death and resurrection in John 11 is the greatest miracle recorded in this Gospel — a powerful sign that Jesus is the resurrection and the life.

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(It was that Mary which anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick.)
- This was the Mary who anointed the Lord with ointment and wiped His feet with her hair. It was her brother Lazarus who was sick.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mary** (*MAIR-ee*) — Hebrew Miryam, meaning "beloved" or "bitter." This Mary is the sister of Martha and Lazarus, from the village of Bethany. She is known for her devoted posture at the feet of Jesus (Luke 10:39) and for anointing Him with costly ointment (John 12:3). She is distinct from Mary the mother of Jesus and Mary Magdalene.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Martha** (MAR-thuh) — Aramaic, meaning "lady" or "mistress of the house." She is the sister of Mary and Lazarus. Martha is known for her active, serving nature (Luke 10:40) and for her bold confession of faith in Jesus as the Christ, the Son of God (John 11:27).

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| <p>3 <i>Therefore his sisters sent unto him, saying, Lord, behold, he whom thou lovest is sick.</i></p> | <p>So His sisters sent word to Jesus, saying, "Lord, the one You love is sick."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>When Jesus heard that, he said, This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God, that the Son of God might be glorified thereby.</i></p> | <p>When Jesus heard this, He said, "This sickness is not unto death. It is for the glory of God, so that the Son of God may be glorified through it."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus.</i></p> | <p>Now Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>When he had heard therefore that he was sick, he abode two days still in the same place where he was.</i></p> | <p>So when He heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed two more days in the place where He was.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Then after that saith he to his disciples, Let us go into Judaea again.</i></p> | <p>After that He said to His disciples, "Let us go to Judaea again."</p> |
| <p>8 <i>His disciples say unto him, Master, the Jews of late sought to stone thee; and goest thou thither again?</i></p> | <p>The disciples said to Him, "Master, the Jews were just trying to stone You, and You are going back there?"</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Jesus answered, Are there not twelve hours in the day? If any man walk in the day, he stumbleth not, because he seeth the light of this world.</i></p> | <p>Jesus answered, "Are there not twelve hours in the day? If anyone walks in the day, he does not stumble, because He sees the light of this world.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>But if a man walk in the night, he stumbleth, because there is no light in him.</i></p> | <p>But if anyone walks in the night, he stumbles, because there is no light in Him."</p> |
| <p>11 <i>These things said he: and after that he saith unto them, Our friend Lazarus sleepeth; but I go, that I may awake him out of sleep.</i></p> | <p>After saying this, He told them, "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep. But I am going to wake him."</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Then said his disciples, Lord, if he sleep, he shall do well.</i></p> | <p>His disciples said, "Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will recover."</p> |

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| 13 <i>Howbeit Jesus spake of his death: but they thought that he had spoken of taking of rest in sleep.</i> | Jesus had spoken of His death, but they thought He was talking about actual sleep. |
| 14 <i>Then said Jesus unto them plainly, Lazarus is dead.</i> | So Jesus told them plainly, "Lazarus is dead. |
| 15 <i>And I am glad for your sakes that I was not there, to the intent ye may believe; nevertheless let us go unto him.</i> | I am glad for Your sake that I was not there — so that You may believe. But let us go to Him." |
| 16 <i>Then said Thomas, which is called Didymus, unto his fellowdisciples, Let us also go, that we may die with him.</i> | Thomas, called Didymus, said to the other disciples, "Let us also go, so that we may die with Him." |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Thomas** (TOM-us) — From the Aramaic word for "twin." He is also called **Didymus** (DID-ih-mus), the Greek word for "twin." Thomas appears in John's Gospel as a disciple marked by honest doubt and deep loyalty. Though he is remembered for doubting the resurrection (John 20:24–25), he also makes one of the greatest confessions of faith: "My Lord and my God" (John 20:28).

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| 17 <i>Then when Jesus came, he found that he had lain in the grave four days already.</i> | When Jesus arrived, He found that Lazarus had already been in the tomb four days. |
| 18 <i>Now Bethany was nigh unto Jerusalem, about fifteen furlongs off:</i> | Bethany was near Jerusalem, about two miles away. |
| 19 <i>And many of the Jews came to Martha and Mary, to comfort them concerning their brother.</i> | Many Jews had come to Martha and Mary to comfort them over the death of their brother. |
| 20 <i>Then Martha, as soon as she heard that Jesus was coming, went and met him: but Mary sat still in the house.</i> | When Martha heard that Jesus was coming, she went to meet Him. But Mary stayed seated in the house. |
| 21 <i>Then said Martha unto Jesus, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.</i> | Martha said to Jesus, "Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died. |
| 22 <i>But I know, that even now, whatsoever thou wilt ask of God, God will give it thee.</i> | But even now I know that whatever You ask of God, God will give You." |

- 23 *Jesus saith unto her, Thy brother shall rise again.* Jesus said to her, "Your brother will rise again."
- 24 *Martha saith unto him, I know that he shall rise again in the resurrection at the last day.* Martha said to him, "I know that he will rise again in the resurrection on the last day."
- 25 *Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live:* Jesus said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. Whoever believes in Me, though he die, yet shall he live."
- 26 *And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this?* And whoever lives and believes in Me shall never die. Do You believe this?"
- 27 *She saith unto him, Yea, Lord: I believe that thou art the Christ, the Son of God, which should come into the world.* She said to Him, "Yes, Lord. I believe that You are the Christ, the Son of God, Who was to come into the world."
- 28 *And when she had so said, she went her way, and called Mary her sister secretly, saying, The Master is come, and calleth for thee.* When she had said this, she went back and called her sister Mary quietly, saying, "The Master is here and is calling for you."
- 29 *As soon as she heard that, she arose quickly, and came unto him.* When Mary heard this, she got up quickly and went to him.
- 30 *Now Jesus was not yet come into the town, but was in that place where Martha met him.* Jesus had not yet entered the village — He was still in the place where Martha had met him.
- 31 *The Jews then which were with her in the house, and comforted her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up hastily and went out, followed her, saying, She goeth unto the grave to weep there.* The Jews who were with Mary in the house comforting her saw her get up quickly and go out. They followed her, thinking she was going to the tomb to weep there.

- 32 *Then when Mary was come where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying unto him, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.* When Mary came where Jesus was and saw Him, she fell at His feet, saying, "Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died."
- 33 *When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews also weeping which came with her, he groaned in the spirit, and was troubled.* When Jesus saw her weeping, and the Jews who had come with her also weeping, He was deeply moved in spirit and troubled.
- 34 *And said, Where have ye laid him? They said unto him, Lord, come and see.* He asked, "Where have You laid Him?" They said to Him, "Lord, come and see."
- 35 *Jesus wept.* Jesus wept.
- 36 *Then said the Jews, Behold how he loved him!* Then the Jews said, "See how He loved Him!"
- 37 *And some of them said, Could not this man, which opened the eyes of the blind, have caused that even this man should not have died?* But some of them said, "Could not this man, who opened the eyes of the blind, have kept this man from dying?"
- 38 *Jesus therefore again groaning in himself cometh to the grave. It was a cave, and a stone lay upon it.* Jesus, deeply moved again, came to the tomb. It was a cave, and a stone was lying against it.
- 39 *Jesus said, Take ye away the stone. Martha, the sister of him that was dead, saith unto him, Lord, by this time he stinketh: for he hath been dead four days.* Jesus said, "Take away the stone." Martha, the sister of the dead man, said to him, "Lord, by this time there is a bad odor — He has been dead four days."
- 40 *Jesus saith unto her, Said I not unto thee, that, if thou wouldest believe, thou shouldest see the glory of God?* Jesus said to her, "Did I not tell You that if You believe, You will see the glory of God?"

- 41 *Then they took away the stone from the place where the dead was laid. And Jesus lifted up his eyes, and said, Father, I thank thee that thou hast heard me.* So they took away the stone. Jesus lifted up His eyes and said, "Father, I thank You that You have heard Me.
- 42 *And I knew that thou hearest me always: but because of the people which stand by I said it, that they may believe that thou hast sent me.* I knew that You always hear Me. But I said this for the sake of the people standing here, so that they may believe that You sent Me."
- 43 *And when he thus had spoken, he cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.* When He had said this, He cried out with a loud voice, "Lazarus, come out!"
- 44 *And he that was dead came forth, bound hand and foot with graveclothes: and his face was bound about with a napkin. Jesus saith unto them, Loose him, and let him go.* The man who had been dead came out, his hands and feet wrapped in burial cloths, and His face wrapped in a cloth. Jesus said to them, "Unwrap Him and let Him go."
- 45 *Then many of the Jews which came to Mary, and had seen the things which Jesus did, believed on him.* Many of the Jews who had come to Mary and had seen what Jesus did believed in Him.
- 46 *But some of them went their ways to the Pharisees, and told them what things Jesus had done.* But some of them went to the Pharisees and told them what Jesus had done.
- 47 *Then gathered the chief priests and the Pharisees a council, and said, What do we? for this man doeth many miracles.* So the chief priests and the Pharisees called a council meeting and said, "What are we doing? This man is performing many signs.
- 48 *If we let him thus alone, all men will believe on him: and the Romans shall come and take away both our place and nation.* If we let Him go on like this, everyone will believe in Him. Then the Romans will come and take away both our temple and our nation."

- 49 *And one of them, named Caiaphas, being the high priest that same year, said unto them, Ye know nothing at all,* But one of them, Caiaphas, who was high priest that year, said to them, "You know nothing at all.
- 50 *Nor consider that it is expedient for us, that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation perish not.* You do not understand that it is better for you that one man should die for the people than that the whole nation should perish."
- 51 *And this spake he not of himself: but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus should die for that nation;* He did not say this of His own accord. Being high priest that year, He prophesied that Jesus would die for that nation.
- 52 *And not for that nation only, but that also he should gather together in one the children of God that were scattered abroad.* Not for that nation only, but also to gather into one the children of God Who were scattered abroad.
- 53 *Then from that day forth they took counsel together for to put him to death.* So from that day on they plotted to put Him to death.
- 54 *Jesus therefore walked no more openly among the Jews; but went thence into a country near to the wilderness, into a city called Ephraim, and there continued with his disciples.* Jesus no longer walked openly among the Jews. He went from there to a region near the wilderness, to a town called Ephraim, and He stayed there with His disciples.
- 55 *And the Jews' passover was nigh at hand: and many went out of the country up to Jerusalem before the passover, to purify themselves.* The Jewish Passover was near. Many people went up to Jerusalem from the countryside before the Passover to purify themselves.
- 56 *Then sought they for Jesus, and spake among themselves, as they stood in the temple, What think ye, that he will not come to the feast?* They were looking for Jesus and saying to one another as they stood in the temple, "What do You think? Will He not come to the feast?"

- 57 *Now both the chief priests and the Pharisees had given a commandment, that, if any man knew where he were, he should shew it, that they might take him.* Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had given orders that if anyone knew where Jesus was, He should report it so they might arrest Him.

Words in this chapter:

Caiaphas (*KY-ah-fas*) — The Jewish high priest during Jesus's trial — he declared it better for one man to die for the nation; he unwittingly prophesied Christ's death for all people.

Lazarus (*LAZ-ah-rus*) — The brother of Mary and Martha whom Jesus raised from the dead after four days in the tomb — his name is a form of Eleazar, meaning 'God has helped.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 12:17; Luke 10:38-42; John 12:9; John 11:11; 2 Kgs 20:1-12
 v2 — John 12:3; Mark 14:3; Matt 26:6-7; Luke 7:37-38
 v4 — John 11:40; John 9:3; 1 Pet 4:14; John 5:23; John 17:5
 v22 — John 9:31; John 11:41-42; Matt 28:18; Mark 9:23
 v24 — Dan 12:2-3; Acts 24:15; John 5:28-29; Isa 26:19; Acts 17:31-32
 v25 — 1 Thess 4:14; John 3:36; 1 John 5:11-12; John 1:4; Rom 8:10-11
 v26 — John 10:28; John 5:24; Rom 8:13; 1 John 5:10-12; John 8:51-53
 v35 — Luke 19:41; Heb 4:15; John 11:33; Isa 53:3; Jer 13:17
 v40 — John 11:4; John 11:23-26; Rom 4:17-25; Ps 63:2; John 1:14
 v41 — Matt 11:25; John 17:1; Ps 123:1; Luke 10:21; Phil 4:6
 v44 — John 5:25; John 20:7; John 11:25-26; Phil 3:21; Luke 7:15
 v52 — John 10:16; Isa 49:6; 1 John 2:2; Eph 1:9-10; 1 Pet 1:1

Chapter 12

Mary anoints Jesus's feet with costly spikenard at Bethany, and Judas objects. Jesus enters Jerusalem riding on a young donkey as the crowd cries 'Hosanna,' fulfilling prophecy. He declares that the hour has come for the Son of man to be glorified and that if He is lifted up, He will draw all men to Himself.

- 1 *Then Jesus six days before the passover came to Bethany, where Lazarus was which had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.* Six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, where Lazarus lived — the one he had raised from the dead.
- 2 *There they made him a supper; and Martha served: but Lazarus was one of them that sat at the table with him.* They made a supper for Him there. Martha served, and Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with Him.

- 3 *Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.* Mary took a pound of very costly ointment of spikenard. She anointed the feet of Jesus and wiped His feet with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the ointment.
- 4 *Then saith one of his disciples, Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, which should betray him,* Then one of His disciples, Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon — the one who would betray him — said,
- 5 *Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?* "Why was this ointment not sold for three hundred coins and given to the poor?"
- 6 *This he said, not that he cared for the poor; but because he was a thief, and had the bag, and bare what was put therein.* He said this not because he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief. He kept the money bag and used to steal from what was put in it.
- 7 *Then said Jesus, Let her alone: against the day of my burying hath she kept this.* Jesus said, "Leave her alone. She has kept it for the day of My burial.
- 8 *For the poor always ye have with you; but me ye have not always.* The poor You will always have with You, but You will not always have Me."
- 9 *Much people of the Jews therefore knew that he was there: and they came not for Jesus' sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.* A large crowd of the Jews learned that He was there. They came not only for Jesus, but also to see Lazarus, whom he had raised from the dead.
- 10 *But the chief priests consulted that they might put Lazarus also to death;* But the chief priests planned to put Lazarus to death as well,
- 11 *Because that by reason of him many of the Jews went away, and believed on Jesus.* because on account of Him, many of the Jews were leaving and believing in Jesus.

- 12 *On the next day much people that were come to the feast, when they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,* The next day, the large crowd that had come to the feast heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem.
- 13 *Took branches of palm trees, and went forth to meet him, and cried, Hosanna: Blessed is the King of Israel that cometh in the name of the Lord.* They took branches of palm trees and went out to meet Him, crying, "Hosanna! Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord — the King of Israel!"
- 14 *And Jesus, when he had found a young ass, sat thereon; as it is written,* Jesus found a young donkey and sat on it, as it is written:
- 15 *Fear not, daughter of Sion: behold, thy King cometh, sitting on an ass's colt.* "Fear not, daughter of Zion. See, Your King is coming, sitting on a donkey's colt."
- 16 *These things understood not his disciples at the first: but when Jesus was glorified, then remembered they that these things were written of him, and that they had done these things unto him.* His disciples did not understand this at first. But when Jesus was glorified, they remembered that these things had been written about Him and that they had done these things to Him.
- 17 *The people therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of his grave, and raised him from the dead, bare record.* The crowd that had been with Him when He called Lazarus out of the tomb and raised him from the dead continued to testify about it.
- 18 *For this cause the people also met him, for that they heard that he had done this miracle.* This was also why the crowd went out to meet Him — because they had heard that He had done this miracle.
- 19 *The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, Perceive ye how ye prevail nothing? behold, the world is gone after him.* So the Pharisees said to one another, "Do you see that you gain nothing? Look — the whole world has gone after Him."
- 20 *And there were certain Greeks among them that came up to worship at the feast:* Now there were some Greeks among those who had come to worship at the feast.

- 21 *The same came therefore to Philip, which was of Bethsaida of Galilee, and desired him, saying, Sir, we would see Jesus.* They came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida in Galilee, and said to Him, "Sir, we wish to see Jesus."
- 22 *Philip cometh and telleth Andrew: and again Andrew and Philip tell Jesus.* Philip went and told Andrew. Andrew and Philip then went and told Jesus.
- 23 *And Jesus answered them, saying, The hour is come, that the Son of man should be glorified.* Jesus answered them, "The hour has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.
- 24 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit.* Truly, truly, I say to You, unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies, it remains alone. But if it dies, it produces much fruit.
- 25 *He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it unto life eternal.* Whoever loves his life will lose it. Whoever hates his life in this world will keep it for eternal life.
- 26 *If any man serve me, let him follow me; and where I am, there shall also my servant be: if any man serve me, him will my Father honour.* If anyone serves Me, let him follow Me. Where I am, My servant will also be. If anyone serves Me, the Father will honor Him.
- 27 *Now is my soul troubled; and what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour: but for this cause came I unto this hour.* Now My soul is troubled. What shall I say? Father, save Me from this hour? No — for this reason I came to this hour.
- 28 *Father, glorify thy name. Then came there a voice from heaven, saying, I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.* Father, glorify Your name." Then a voice came from heaven: "I have glorified it, and I will glorify it again."
- 29 *The people therefore, that stood by, and heard it, said that it thundered: others said, An angel spake to him.* The crowd standing there heard it and said it was thunder. Others said, "An angel spoke to Him."

- 30 *Jesus answered and said, This voice came not because of me, but for your sakes.* Jesus answered, "This voice came not for My sake, but for Yours.
- 31 *Now is the judgment of this world: now shall the prince of this world be cast out.* Now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be cast out.
- 32 *And I, if I be lifted up from the earth, will draw all men unto me.* And I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to Myself."
- 33 *This he said, signifying what death he should die.* He said this to show what kind of death He was going to die.
- 34 *The people answered him, We have heard out of the law that Christ abideth for ever: and how sayest thou, The Son of man must be lifted up? who is this Son of man?* The crowd answered Him, "We have heard from the law that the Christ remains forever. How can You say, 'The Son of Man must be lifted up'? Who is this Son of Man?"
- 35 *Then Jesus said unto them, Yet a little while is the light with you. Walk while ye have the light, lest darkness come upon you: for he that walketh in darkness knoweth not whither he goeth.* Jesus said to them, "The light is with You for a little while longer. Walk while You have the light, so that darkness does not overtake You. The one who walks in darkness does not know where he is going.
- 36 *While ye have light, believe in the light, that ye may be the children of light. These things spake Jesus, and departed, and did hide himself from them.* While You have the light, believe in the light, so that You may become children of light." When Jesus had said this, He departed and hid Himself from them.
- 37 *But though he had done so many miracles before them, yet they believed not on him:* Although He had done so many miracles before them, they still did not believe in Him,
- 38 *That the saying of Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spake, Lord, who hath believed our report? and to whom hath the arm of the Lord been revealed?* so that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled: "Lord, who has believed our report? To whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?"

- 39 *Therefore they could not believe, because that Esaias said again,* For this reason they could not believe. Isaiah also said,
- 40 *He hath blinded their eyes, and hardened their heart; that they should not see with their eyes, nor understand with their heart, and be converted, and I should heal them.* "He has blinded their eyes and hardened their hearts, so that they would not see with their eyes or understand with their hearts and turn, and I would heal them."
- 41 *These things said Esaias, when he saw his glory, and spake of him.* Isaiah said these things because he saw his glory and spoke of Him.
- 42 *Nevertheless among the chief rulers also many believed on him; but because of the Pharisees they did not confess him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue:* Nevertheless, even among the rulers many believed in Him. But because of the Pharisees they did not confess it, so they would not be put out of the synagogue.
- 43 *For they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.* They loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.
- 44 *Jesus cried and said, He that believeth on me, believeth not on me, but on him that sent me.* Jesus cried out and said, "Whoever believes in Me does not believe in Me alone, but in Him who sent Me.
- 45 *And he that seeth me seeth him that sent me.* Whoever sees Me sees him who sent Me.
- 46 *I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on me should not abide in darkness.* I have come as a light into the world, so that whoever believes in Me should not remain in darkness.
- 47 *And if any man hear my words, and believe not, I judge him not: for I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.* If anyone hears My words and does not believe, I do not judge Him — for I came not to judge the world but to save the world.
- 48 *He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day.* Whoever rejects Me and does not receive My words has a judge — the very word I have spoken will judge Him on the last day.

- 49 *For I have not spoken of myself; but the Father which sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say, and what I should speak.* I have not spoken on My own authority. The Father who sent Me has Himself commanded Me what to say and what to speak.
- 50 *And I know that his commandment is life everlasting: whatsoever I speak therefore, even as the Father said unto me, so I speak.* I know that His commandment is everlasting life. So whatever I speak, I speak just as the Father has told Me."

Words in this chapter:

Hosanna (*ho-ZAN-ah*) — Hebrew cry meaning 'Save us, we pray!' — used as a shout of praise and welcome for the coming King.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v24** — 1 Cor 15:36-38; Isa 53:10-12; Heb 2:9-10; John 12:32-33; Rev 7:9-17
v25 — Matt 10:39; Luke 9:23-24; Mark 8:35; Luke 17:33; Matt 16:25
v26 — Col 3:24; 1 Sam 2:30; Gal 1:10; John 10:27; John 17:24
v31 — 2 Cor 4:4; 1 John 3:8; 1 John 5:19; John 14:30; Eph 6:12
v32 — John 8:28; John 3:14; 1 Pet 2:24; 1 John 2:2; John 1:7
v34 — Ezek 37:24-25; Isa 9:7; Dan 7:14; Ps 110:4; Dan 7:27
v38 — Isa 53:1; Rom 10:16; Rom 10:20; 1 Cor 1:24; 2 Cor 4:3-6
v40 — Isa 6:10; Matt 13:13-15; Luke 8:10; Mark 4:12; Isa 57:18-19
v43 — John 5:44; Matt 23:5-7; John 5:41; Luke 16:15; 2 Cor 10:18
v46 — John 8:12; Ps 36:9; Isa 42:7; John 9:5; John 12:35-36
v48 — Luke 10:16; Heb 9:27-28; Rom 2:16; 2 Thess 1:8; John 3:17-20
v49 — John 14:10; John 8:26; John 5:30; John 17:8; Deut 18:18

Chapter 13

Jesus washes His disciples' feet at the Last Supper, commanding them to serve one another as He has served them. He reveals that one of them will betray Him, and Judas goes out into the night. Jesus gives a new commandment: 'Love one another, as I have loved you.'

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| 1 <i>Now before the feast of the passover, when Jesus knew that his hour was come that he should depart out of this world unto the Father, having loved his own which were in the world, he loved them unto the end.</i> | Before the feast of the Passover, Jesus knew that His hour had come to depart from this world to the Father. Having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the end. |
| 2 <i>And supper being ended, the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him;</i> | During supper, the devil had already put it into the heart of Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon, to betray him. |
| 3 <i>Jesus knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he was come from God, and went to God;</i> | Jesus knew that the Father had given all things into His hands, and that He had come from God and was going to God. |
| 4 <i>He riseth from supper, and laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.</i> | He rose from supper, laid aside His outer garments, and took a towel and wrapped it around Himself. |
| 5 <i>After that he poureth water into a bason, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded.</i> | Then He poured water into a basin and began to wash the disciples' feet, wiping them with the towel He had wrapped around Himself. |
| 6 <i>Then cometh he to Simon Peter: and Peter saith unto him, Lord, dost thou wash my feet?</i> | He came to Simon Peter, who said to him, "Lord, are you washing my feet?" |
| 7 <i>Jesus answered and said unto him, What I do thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter.</i> | Jesus answered, "You do not understand what I am doing now, but You will understand afterward." |
| 8 <i>Peter saith unto him, Thou shalt never wash my feet. Jesus answered him, If I wash thee not, thou hast no part with me.</i> | Peter said to him, "You shall never wash my feet." Jesus answered, "If I do not wash You, You have no part with Me." |
| 9 <i>Simon Peter saith unto him, Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head.</i> | Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!" |

- 10 *Jesus saith to him, He that is washed needeth not save to wash his feet, but is clean every whit: and ye are clean, but not all.* Jesus said to Him, "The one who has bathed does not need to wash except for His feet — he is completely clean. You are clean, but not all of You."
- 11 *For he knew who should betray him; therefore said he, Ye are not all clean.* For He knew who was going to betray Him. That is why He said, "Not all of You are clean."
- 12 *So after he had washed their feet, and had taken his garments, and was set down again, he said unto them, Know ye what I have done to you?* When He had washed their feet and put on His garments and sat down again, He said to them, "Do You understand what I have done to You?"
- 13 *Ye call me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am.* You call Me Master and Lord, and You are right, for that is what I am.
- 14 *If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.* If I then, Your Lord and Master, have washed Your feet, You also ought to wash one another's feet.
- 15 *For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you.* I have given You an example, so that You should do just as I have done to You.
- 16 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him.* Truly, truly, I say to You, a servant is not greater than His master, nor is a messenger greater than the one who sent him.
- 17 *If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.* If You know these things, You are blessed if You do them.
- 18 *I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen: but that the scripture may be fulfilled, He that eateth bread with me hath lifted up his heel against me.* I am not speaking of all of You. I know those I have chosen. But the Scripture must be fulfilled: 'He who ate bread with Me has lifted up his heel against Me.'
- 19 *Now I tell you before it come, that, when it is come to pass, ye may believe that I am he.* I am telling You this now, before it happens, so that when it does happen You may believe that I am He.

- 20 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth me; and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.* Truly, truly, I say to You, whoever receives the one I send receives Me. Whoever receives Me receives him who sent Me."
- 21 *When Jesus had thus said, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.* When Jesus had said this, He was troubled in spirit. He testified and said, "Truly, truly, I say to You, one of You will betray Me."
- 22 *Then the disciples looked one on another, doubting of whom he spake.* The disciples looked at one another, uncertain of whom He was speaking.
- 23 *Now there was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved.* One of His disciples — the one whom Jesus loved — was reclining at Jesus' side.
- 24 *Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, that he should ask who it should be of whom he spake.* Simon Peter motioned to him to ask Jesus whom He meant.
- 25 *He then lying on Jesus' breast saith unto him, Lord, who is it?* That disciple leaned back against Jesus and said to Him, "Lord, who is it?"
- 26 *Jesus answered, He it is, to whom I shall give a sop, when I have dipped it. And when he had dipped the sop, he gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon.* Jesus answered, "It is the one to whom I will give this piece of bread after I have dipped it." He dipped the piece of bread and gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon.
- 27 *And after the sop Satan entered into him. Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.* After Judas took the bread, Satan entered into him. Jesus said to Him, "What You are going to do, do quickly."
- 28 *Now no man at the table knew for what intent he spake this unto him.* None of those at the table knew why He said this to Him.
- 29 *For some of them thought, because Judas had the bag, that Jesus had said unto him, Buy those things that we have need of against the feast; or, that he should give something to the poor.* Some thought that, since Judas had the money bag, Jesus was telling Him to buy what they needed for the feast, or that He should give something to the poor.

- 30 *He then having received the sop went immediately out: and it was night.* So after receiving the piece of bread, Judas went out immediately. It was night.
- 31 *Therefore, when he was gone out, Jesus said, Now is the Son of man glorified, and God is glorified in him.* When He had gone out, Jesus said, "Now the Son of Man is glorified, and God is glorified in Him.
- 32 *If God be glorified in him, God shall also glorify him in himself, and shall straightway glorify him.* If God is glorified in Him, God will also glorify Him in Himself, and He will glorify Him at once.
- 33 *Little children, yet a little while I am with you. Ye shall seek me: and as I said unto the Jews, Whither I go, ye cannot come; so now I say to you.* Little children, I am with You only a little while longer. You will seek Me. As I said to the Jews, 'Where I am going You cannot come,' so I say to You now.
- 34 *A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.* A new commandment I give to You: that You love one another. Just as I have loved You, You also are to love one another.
- 35 *By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.* By this all people will know that You are My disciples — if You have love for one another."
- 36 *Simon Peter said unto him, Lord, whither goest thou? Jesus answered him, Whither I go, thou canst not follow me now; but thou shalt follow me afterwards.* Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, where are you going?" Jesus answered, "Where I am going You cannot follow Me now, but You will follow afterward."
- 37 *Peter said unto him, Lord, why cannot I follow thee now? I will lay down my life for thy sake.* Peter said, "Lord, why can I not follow you now? I will lay down my life for You."
- 38 *Jesus answered him, Wilt thou lay down thy life for my sake? Verily, verily, I say unto thee, The cock shall not crow, till thou hast denied me thrice.* Jesus answered, "Will You lay down Your life for Me? Truly, truly, I say to You, the rooster will not crow until You have denied Me three times."

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 12:23; 1 John 4:19; John 13:34; John 16:28; John 13:3
 v3 — John 3:35; Matt 11:27; Heb 1:2; Matt 28:18; John 17:2
 v7 — Dan 12:8; John 12:16; John 14:26; Jas 5:7-11; John 13:10-12
 v8 — Titus 3:5; Ezek 36:25; Acts 22:16; Heb 10:22; Eph 5:26
 v14 — 1 Pet 5:5; Acts 20:35; Rom 12:16; Gal 5:13; Luke 22:26-27
 v16 — Luke 6:40; John 15:20; Matt 10:24-25; John 3:5
 v17 — Luke 11:28; Jas 4:17; Jas 1:25; Matt 7:24-25; Luke 12:47-48
 v18 — Ps 41:9; Matt 26:23; John 17:12; Mark 14:20; John 13:26
 v20 — Luke 10:16; Luke 9:48; Mark 9:37; Matt 25:40; Matt 10:40-42
 v23 — John 19:26; John 21:7; John 20:2; John 21:20; Rev 1:16-18
 v34 — Eph 5:2; Lev 19:18; John 15:17; 1 Pet 1:22; Gal 6:2
 v35 — 1 John 4:20-21; 1 John 2:10; 1 John 3:10-14; John 17:21; 1 John 2:5

Chapter 14

Jesus comforts His disciples, telling them He goes to prepare a place for them and that He is the way, the truth, and the life. He promises to send the Comforter — the Holy Ghost — who will teach them all things and bring to remembrance everything He has said.

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| 1 | <i>Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me.</i> | "Do not let Your hearts be troubled. You believe in God — believe also in Me. |
| 2 | <i>In my Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you.</i> | In My Father's house there are many mansions. If it were not so, I would have told You. I am going to prepare a place for You. |
| 3 | <i>And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.</i> | And if I go and prepare a place for You, I will come again and receive You to Myself, so that where I am, there You may be also. |
| 4 | <i>And whither I go ye know, and the way ye know.</i> | And where I am going, You know the way." |

- 5 *Thomas saith unto him, Lord, we know not whither thou goest; and how can we know the way?* Thomas said to him, "Lord, we do not know where you are going. How can we know the way?"
- 6 *Jesus saith unto him, I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.* Jesus said to Him, "I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me.
- 7 *If ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also: and from henceforth ye know him, and have seen him.* If You had known Me, You would have known My Father also. From now on, You do know Him and have seen Him."
- 8 *Philip saith unto him, Lord, shew us the Father, and it sufficeth us.* Philip said to him, "Lord, show us the Father, and that is enough for us."
- 9 *Jesus saith unto him, Have I been so long time with you, and yet hast thou not known me, Philip? he that hath seen me hath seen the Father; and how sayest thou then, Shew us the Father?* Jesus said to Him, "Have I been with You so long, and You still do not know Me, Philip? Whoever has seen Me has seen the Father. How can You say, 'Show us the Father'?"
- 10 *Believest thou not that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? the words that I speak unto you I speak not of myself: but the Father that dwelleth in me, he doeth the works.* Do You not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me? The words I say to You I do not speak on My own authority. The Father who lives in Me does His works.
- 11 *Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me: or else believe me for the very works' sake.* Believe Me that I am in the Father and the Father in Me — or else believe because of the works themselves.
- 12 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father.* Truly, truly, I say to You, whoever believes in Me will do the works I do. He will do even greater works than these, because I am going to the Father.
- 13 *And whatsoever ye shall ask in my name, that will I do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.* Whatever You ask in My name, that I will do, so that the Father may be glorified in the Son.

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| 14 <i>If ye shall ask any thing in my name, I will do it.</i> | If You ask anything in My name, I will do it. |
| 15 <i>If ye love me, keep my commandments.</i> | If You love Me, keep My commandments. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Comforter** (KUM-fer-ter) — *The Holy Ghost, the third Person of the Trinity, whom Jesus promised to send to His followers. Some translations say "Helper" or "Advocate" — the KJV says Comforter, the One who walks alongside you, strengthens you, and never leaves. He is not merely a feeling but a Person.*

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| 16 <i>And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever;</i> | I will ask the Father, and He will give You another Comforter, to be with You forever — |
| 17 <i>Even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you.</i> | even the Spirit of truth. The world cannot receive Him, because it neither sees Him nor knows Him. But You know Him, for He lives with You and will be in You. |
| 18 <i>I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you.</i> | I will not leave You comfortless. I will come to You. |
| 19 <i>Yet a little while, and the world seeth me no more; but ye see me: because I live, ye shall live also.</i> | A little while longer and the world will see Me no more. But You will see Me. Because I live, You will live also. |
| 20 <i>At that day ye shall know that I am in my Father, and ye in me, and I in you.</i> | On that day You will know that I am in My Father, and You are in Me, and I am in You. |
| 21 <i>He that hath my commandments, and keepeth them, he it is that loveth me: and he that loveth me shall be loved of my Father, and I will love him, and will manifest myself to him.</i> | Whoever has My commandments and keeps them — he is the one who loves Me. Whoever loves Me will be loved by My Father, and I will love Him and reveal Myself to Him." |
| 22 <i>Judas saith unto him, not Iscariot, Lord, how is it that thou wilt manifest thyself unto us, and not unto the world?</i> | Judas — not Iscariot — said to him, "Lord, how is it that You will reveal Yourself to us and not to the world?" |

- 23 *Jesus answered and said unto him, If a man love me, he will keep my words: and my Father will love him, and we will come unto him, and make our abode with him.* Jesus answered Him, "If anyone loves Me, he will keep My word. My Father will love Him, and We will come to Him and make Our home with Him.
- 24 *He that loveth me not keepeth not my sayings: and the word which ye hear is not mine, but the Father's which sent me.* Whoever does not love Me does not keep My words. The word You hear is not Mine, but the Father's who sent Me.
- 25 *These things have I spoken unto you, being yet present with you.* I have said these things while I am still with You.
- 26 *But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.* But the Comforter — the Holy Ghost — whom the Father will send in My name, He will teach You all things and bring to Your remembrance all that I have said to You.
- 27 *Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, give I unto you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.* Peace I leave with You. My peace I give to You. Not as the world gives do I give to You. Do not let Your hearts be troubled, and do not be afraid.
- 28 *Ye have heard how I said unto you, I go away, and come again unto you. If ye loved me, ye would rejoice, because I said, I go unto the Father: for my Father is greater than I.* You heard Me say, 'I am going away, and I will come back to You.' If You loved Me, You would rejoice, because I am going to the Father — for the Father is greater than I.
- 29 *And now I have told you before it come to pass, that, when it is come to pass, ye might believe.* I have told You this now, before it happens, so that when it does happen You may believe.
- 30 *Hereafter I will not talk much with you: for the prince of this world cometh, and hath nothing in me.* I will not talk much more with you, for the prince of this world is coming. He has no claim on Me.

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| <p>31 <i>But that the world may know that I love the Father; and as the Father gave me commandment, even so I do. Arise, let us go hence.</i></p> | <p>But the world must know that I love the Father and do exactly as the Father commanded Me. Rise, let us go from here."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Comforter — The Helper who walks alongside — the Holy Spirit, sent by Christ; some translations say 'Helper' or 'Advocate,' but KJV says Comforter.

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 26:3; John 16:22-23; Isa 12:2-3; John 14:27-28; 2 Cor 12:9-10
v3 — 1 Thess 4:16-17; 2 Tim 2:12; John 12:26; Acts 1:11; Heb 9:28
v6 — Acts 4:12; John 10:9; Eph 2:18; John 11:25-26; John 1:4
v9 — Col 1:15; John 12:45; John 14:7; Heb 1:3; John 10:30
v12 — Matt 21:21; Mark 16:17; Luke 10:17-19; Acts 16:18; Acts 19:12
v13 — John 15:7; Mark 11:24; Matt 7:7; Matt 21:22; 1 John 5:14
v15 — 1 John 2:3-5; 1 John 5:2-3; John 14:21-24; 2 John 1:6; John 15:10-14
v16 — John 14:26; John 15:26; John 16:7-15; Rom 15:13; Rom 8:26-27
v21 — John 14:15; 1 John 5:3; 1 John 2:5; 2 John 1:6; John 15:9-10
v23 — John 14:21; John 14:15; Rev 3:20-21; 1 John 4:15-16; 1 John 2:24
v26 — John 15:26; John 14:16; 1 Cor 2:10-13; 1 John 2:27; John 16:7
v27 — Phil 4:7; John 16:33; Isa 41:10; 2 Thess 3:16; Col 3:15

Chapter 15

Jesus teaches, 'I am the true vine,' and calls His disciples to abide in Him as branches abide in the vine. He commands them to love one another as He has loved them, warns that the world will hate them as it hated Him, and promises that the Comforter will come to testify of Him.

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| <p>1 <i>I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.</i></p> | <p>"I am the true vine, and My Father is the vinedresser.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.</i></p> | <p>Every branch in Me that does not bear fruit He takes away. Every branch that does bear fruit He prunes, so that it may bear more fruit.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.</i></p> | <p>You are already clean because of the word I have spoken to You.</p> |

- 4 *Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abide in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me.* Remain in Me, and I in You. Just as the branch cannot bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, neither can You, unless You remain in Me.
- 5 *I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.* I am the vine; You are the branches. Whoever remains in Me, and I in him, he bears much fruit. Apart from Me You can do nothing.
- 6 *If a man abide not in me, he is cast forth as a branch, and is withered; and men gather them, and cast them into the fire, and they are burned.* If anyone does not remain in Me, he is thrown away like a branch and withers. Such branches are gathered, thrown into the fire, and burned.
- 7 *If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.* If You remain in Me and My words remain in You, ask whatever You wish, and it will be done for You.
- 8 *Herein is my Father glorified, that ye bear much fruit; so shall ye be my disciples.* This is how My Father is glorified — that You bear much fruit and show yourselves to be My disciples.
- 9 *As the Father hath loved me, so have I loved you: continue ye in my love.* As the Father has loved Me, so I have loved You. Remain in My love.
- 10 *If ye keep my commandments, ye shall abide in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments, and abide in his love.* If You keep My commandments, You will remain in My love, just as I have kept My Father's commandments and remain in His love.
- 11 *These things have I spoken unto you, that my joy might remain in you, and that your joy might be full.* I have said these things to You so that My joy may be in You, and that Your joy may be complete.
- 12 *This is my commandment, That ye love one another, as I have loved you.* This is My commandment: that You love one another as I have loved You.
- 13 *Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.* No one has greater love than this — that someone lay down his life for his friends.
- 14 *Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you.* You are My friends if You do what I command You.

- 15 *Henceforth I call you not servants; for the servant knoweth not what his lord doeth: but I have called you friends; for all things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.* I no longer call You servants, because a servant does not know what His master is doing. I have called You friends, for I have made known to You everything I have heard from My Father.
- 16 *Ye have not chosen me, but I have chosen you, and ordained you, that ye should go and bring forth fruit, and that your fruit should remain: that whatsoever ye shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you.* You did not choose Me, but I chose You. I appointed You to go and bear fruit — fruit that will last — so that whatever You ask the Father in My name, He may give it to You.
- 17 *These things I command you, that ye love one another.* These things I command You: that You love one another.
- 18 *If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.* If the world hates You, know that it hated Me before it hated You.
- 19 *If ye were of the world, the world would love his own: but because ye are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hateth you.* If You were of the world, the world would love You as its own. But because You are not of the world — because I chose You out of the world — the world hates You.
- 20 *Remember the word that I said unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep yours also.* Remember the word I said to You: 'A servant is not greater than His master.' If they persecuted Me, they will also persecute You. If they kept My word, they will keep Yours also.
- 21 *But all these things will they do unto you for my name's sake, because they know not him that sent me.* They will do all these things to You on account of My name, because they do not know Him who sent Me.
- 22 *If I had not come and spoken unto them, they had not had sin: but now they have no cloke for their sin.* If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have had sin. But now they have no excuse for their sin.

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| 23 | <i>He that hateth me hateth my Father also.</i> | Whoever hates Me hates My Father also. |
| 24 | <i>If I had not done among them the works which none other man did, they had not had sin: but now have they both seen and hated both me and my Father.</i> | If I had not done among them the works that no one else did, they would not have had sin. But now they have seen and hated both Me and My Father. |
| 25 | <i>But this cometh to pass, that the word might be fulfilled that is written in their law, They hated me without a cause.</i> | But this has happened so that the word written in their law might be fulfilled: 'They hated Me without cause.' |
| 26 | <i>But when the Comforter is come, whom I will send unto you from the Father, even the Spirit of truth, which proceedeth from the Father, he shall testify of me:</i> | But when the Comforter comes — whom I will send to You from the Father, the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father — He will testify about Me. |
| 27 | <i>And ye also shall bear witness, because ye have been with me from the beginning.</i> | And You also will testify, because You have been with Me from the beginning. |

Words in this chapter:

Comforter — The Helper who walks alongside — the Holy Spirit, sent by Christ; some translations say 'Helper' or 'Advocate,' but KJV says Comforter.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Jer 2:21; Isa 27:2-3; 1 Cor 3:9; Isa 60:21; Ps 80:8-19
- v2 — Matt 3:10; Heb 12:10-11; Matt 15:13; Rev 3:19; John 15:8
- v3 — John 17:17; Eph 5:26; 1 Pet 1:22; John 13:10
- v4 — 1 John 2:6; Gal 2:20; John 8:31; 2 John 1:9; John 6:56
- v5 — Phil 4:13; Col 1:10; John 15:16; Gal 5:22; Prov 11:30
- v7 — Ps 37:4; 1 John 5:14; John 14:13; 1 John 3:22; John 15:16
- v8 — Matt 5:16; John 8:31; Phil 1:11; 2 Cor 9:10-15; John 15:5
- v10 — John 14:15; 1 John 5:3; 1 John 3:21-24; 1 John 2:5; 2 Pet 2:21
- v12 — 1 John 4:21; 1 Pet 4:8; John 13:34; Eph 5:2; Rom 12:10
- v13 — John 10:11; Eph 5:2; Rom 5:6-8; John 10:15; 1 John 4:7-11
- v15 — Ps 25:14; 1 Cor 2:9-12; Matt 13:11; Jas 2:23; Col 1:26
- v16 — Jer 1:5-7; John 15:19; Eph 2:10; 2 Tim 3:15-17; 1 John 4:19

Chapter 16

Jesus warns His disciples that they will be put out of the synagogues and that those who kill them will think they are serving God. He promises that the Comforter will come to convict the world of sin, righteousness, and judgment. He tells them that their sorrow will be turned to joy, and declares, 'I have overcome the world.'

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| 1 | <i>These things have I spoken unto you, that ye should not be offended.</i> | "I have told You these things so that You will not fall away. |
| 2 | <i>They shall put you out of the synagogues: yea, the time cometh, that whosoever killeth you will think that he doeth God service.</i> | They will put You out of the synagogues. Indeed, the hour is coming when whoever kills you will think he is offering service to God. |
| 3 | <i>And these things will they do unto you, because they have not known the Father, nor me.</i> | They will do these things because they have not known the Father or Me. |
| 4 | <i>But these things have I told you, that when the time shall come, ye may remember that I told you of them. And these things I said not unto you at the beginning, because I was with you.</i> | I have said these things to You so that when their hour comes You may remember that I told You of them. I did not say this to You from the beginning, because I was with You. |
| 5 | <i>But now I go my way to him that sent me; and none of you asketh me, Whither goest thou?</i> | But now I am going to Him who sent Me. None of You asks Me, 'Where are You going?' |
| 6 | <i>But because I have said these things unto you, sorrow hath filled your heart.</i> | But because I have said these things, sorrow has filled Your hearts. |
| 7 | <i>Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.</i> | But I tell You the truth: it is to Your benefit that I go away. For if I do not go away, the Comforter will not come to You. But if I go, I will send Him to You. |
| 8 | <i>And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment:</i> | When He comes, He will convict the world concerning sin, and righteousness, and judgment: |

- 9 *Of sin, because they believe not on me;* concerning sin, because they do not believe in Me;
- 10 *Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more;* concerning righteousness, because I go to the Father and You will see Me no more;
- 11 *Of judgment, because the prince of this world is judged.* concerning judgment, because the prince of this world is judged.
- 12 *I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.* I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now.
- 13 *Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.* When the Spirit of truth comes, He will guide You into all truth. He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak. He will declare to You the things that are to come.
- 14 *He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.* He will glorify Me, for He will take what is Mine and declare it to You.
- 15 *All things that the Father hath are mine: therefore said I, that he shall take of mine, and shall shew it unto you.* All that the Father has is Mine. That is why I said He will take what is Mine and declare it to You.
- 16 *A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me, because I go to the Father.* A little while and You will see Me no more. Then again a little while, and You will see Me, because I am going to the Father."
- 17 *Then said some of his disciples among themselves, What is this that he saith unto us, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me: and, Because I go to the Father?* Some of His disciples said to one another, "What does He mean by saying, 'A little while and You will not see Me, and again a little while and You will see Me,' and 'because I am going to the Father'?"

- 18 *They said therefore, What is this that he saith, A little while? we cannot tell what he saith.* They kept asking, "What does He mean by 'a little while'? We do not know what He is talking about."
- 19 *Now Jesus knew that they were desirous to ask him, and said unto them, Do ye enquire among yourselves of that I said, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me?* Jesus knew they wanted to ask Him, so He said to them, "Are You discussing among yourselves what I meant by 'a little while and You will not see Me, and again a little while and You will see Me'?"
- 20 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, That ye shall weep and lament, but the world shall rejoice: and ye shall be sorrowful, but your sorrow shall be turned into joy.* Truly, truly, I say to You, You will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. You will be sorrowful, but Your sorrow will turn to joy.
- 21 *A woman when she is in travail hath sorrow, because her hour is come: but as soon as she is delivered of the child, she remembereth no more the anguish, for joy that a man is born into the world.* When a woman is giving birth, she has sorrow because her hour has come. But when she has delivered the baby, she no longer remembers the anguish, for joy that a child has been born into the world.
- 22 *And ye now therefore have sorrow: but I will see you again, and your heart shall rejoice, and your joy no man taketh from you.* So also You have sorrow now. But I will see You again, and Your hearts will rejoice. No one will take your joy from you.
- 23 *And in that day ye shall ask me nothing. Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.* On that day You will ask Me nothing. Truly, truly, I say to You, whatever You ask the Father in My name, He will give it to You.
- 24 *Hitherto have ye asked nothing in my name: ask, and ye shall receive, that your joy may be full.* Until now You have asked nothing in My name. Ask, and You will receive, so that Your joy may be complete.

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| 25 <i>These things have I spoken unto you in proverbs: but the time cometh, when I shall no more speak unto you in proverbs, but I shall shew you plainly of the Father.</i> | I have said these things to You in figures of speech. The hour is coming when I will no longer speak in figures but will tell You plainly about the Father. |
| 26 <i>At that day ye shall ask in my name: and I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you:</i> | On that day You will ask in My name. I am not saying that I will ask the Father on Your behalf — |
| 27 <i>For the Father himself loveth you, because ye have loved me, and have believed that I came out from God.</i> | for the Father Himself loves You, because You have loved Me and have believed that I came from God. |
| 28 <i>I came forth from the Father, and am come into the world: again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.</i> | I came from the Father and entered the world. Now I am leaving the world and going back to the Father." |
| 29 <i>His disciples said unto him, Lo, now speakest thou plainly, and speakest no proverb.</i> | His disciples said, "Now You are speaking plainly and not using figures of speech. |
| 30 <i>Now are we sure that thou knowest all things, and needest not that any man should ask thee: by this we believe that thou camest forth from God.</i> | Now we know that You know all things. You do not need anyone to ask you anything. By this we believe that You came from God." |
| 31 <i>Jesus answered them, Do ye now believe?</i> | Jesus answered them, "Do You now believe? |
| 32 <i>Behold, the hour cometh, yea, is now come, that ye shall be scattered, every man to his own, and shall leave me alone: and yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.</i> | The hour is coming — indeed, it has already come — when You will be scattered, each to His own home, and will leave Me alone. Yet I am not alone, for the Father is with Me. |
| 33 <i>These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace. In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.</i> | I have said these things to You so that in Me You may have peace. In the world You will have trouble. But take courage — I have overcome the world." |
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Words in this chapter:

Comforter — The Helper who walks alongside — the Holy Spirit, sent by Christ; some translations say 'Helper' or 'Advocate,' but KJV says Comforter.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 2:8; Matt 13:21; Matt 26:31-33; Matt 24:10; John 15:18-27
- v2 — John 9:22; Acts 26:9-11; Rom 10:2-3; Matt 10:28; Acts 22:3-4
- v7 — John 14:26; John 14:16-17; John 15:26; Acts 2:33; John 7:39
- v11 — John 12:31; 1 John 3:8; Heb 2:14; John 14:30; Col 2:15
- v13 — John 14:26; 1 Cor 2:10-13; John 14:17; John 15:26; 1 John 2:27
- v15 — John 17:10; Matt 11:27; John 3:35; Luke 10:22; Col 1:19
- v20 — Jas 1:2; Matt 5:4; Rev 7:14-17; Ps 126:5-6; Mark 16:10
- v22 — 1 Pet 1:8; Acts 13:52; John 16:6; 2 Thess 2:16; Isa 25:9
- v23 — John 15:7; John 14:13-14; Matt 21:22; 1 John 5:14-16; Isa 65:24
- v24 — Matt 7:7-8; Jas 4:2-3; John 15:11; 2 Thess 2:16-17; John 16:23
- v32 — Zech 13:7; Matt 26:31; John 8:29; Mark 14:27; John 8:16
- v33 — John 14:27; 1 John 5:4; 2 Thess 3:16; 1 John 4:4; Phil 4:7

Chapter 17

Jesus prays to the Father, asking Him to glorify the Son so that the Son may glorify the Father. He prays for His disciples, asking the Father to keep them from the evil one and to sanctify them through the truth. He prays for all who will believe through their word, that they may be one as He and the Father are one.

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| <p>1 <i>These words spake Jesus, and lifted up his eyes to heaven, and said, Father, the hour is come; glorify thy Son, that thy Son also may glorify thee:</i></p> | <p>When Jesus had said these things, He lifted up His eyes to heaven and said, "Father, the hour has come. Glorify Your Son so that the Son may glorify You,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>As thou hast given him power over all flesh, that he should give eternal life to as many as thou hast given him.</i></p> | <p>just as You have given Him authority over all flesh, to give eternal life to all whom You have given Him.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And this is life eternal, that they might know thee the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent.</i></p> | <p>And this is eternal life: that they may know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ whom You have sent.</p> |

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| 4 | <i>I have glorified thee on the earth: I have finished the work which thou gavest me to do.</i> | I have glorified You on earth. I have finished the work You gave Me to do. |
| 5 | <i>And now, O Father, glorify thou me with thine own self with the glory which I had with thee before the world was.</i> | Now, Father, glorify Me in Your own presence with the glory I had with You before the world existed. |
| 6 | <i>I have manifested thy name unto the men which thou gavest me out of the world: thine they were, and thou gavest them me; and they have kept thy word.</i> | I have made Your name known to the people you gave Me out of the world. They were Yours, and You gave them to Me, and they have kept Your word. |
| 7 | <i>Now they have known that all things whatsoever thou hast given me are of thee.</i> | Now they know that everything You have given Me is from You. |
| 8 | <i>For I have given unto them the words which thou gavest me; and they have received them, and have known surely that I came out from thee, and they have believed that thou didst send me.</i> | I have given them the words You gave Me, and they have received them. They know truly that I came from You, and they have believed that You sent Me. |
| 9 | <i>I pray for them: I pray not for the world, but for them which thou hast given me; for they are thine.</i> | I am praying for them. I am not praying for the world, but for those You have given Me, for they are Yours. |
| 10 | <i>And all mine are thine, and thine are mine; and I am glorified in them.</i> | All that is Mine is Yours, and what is Yours is Mine, and I am glorified in them. |
| 11 | <i>And now I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I come to thee. Holy Father, keep through thine own name those whom thou hast given me, that they may be one, as we are.</i> | I am no longer in the world, but they are in the world, and I am coming to You. Holy Father, keep them in Your name — the name You have given Me — so that they may be one, just as We are one. |

- 12 *While I was with them in the world, I kept them in thy name: those that thou gavest me I have kept, and none of them is lost, but the son of perdition; that the scripture might be fulfilled.* While I was with them, I kept them in Your name. I protected those You gave Me, and none of them has been lost except the son of perdition, so that the Scripture might be fulfilled.
- 13 *And now come I to thee; and these things I speak in the world, that they might have my joy fulfilled in themselves.* Now I am coming to You. I say these things while I am still in the world, so that they may have My joy made complete in themselves.
- 14 *I have given them thy word; and the world hath hated them, because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.* I have given them Your word, and the world has hated them because they are not of the world, just as I am not of the world.
- 15 *I pray not that thou shouldest take them out of the world, but that thou shouldest keep them from the evil.* I am not asking You to take them out of the world, but to keep them from the evil one.
- 16 *They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.* They are not of the world, just as I am not of the world.
- 17 *Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.* Sanctify them in Your truth — Your word is truth.
- 18 *As thou hast sent me into the world, even so have I also sent them into the world.* As You sent Me into the world, I also have sent them into the world.
- 19 *And for their sakes I sanctify myself, that they also might be sanctified through the truth.* For their sake I sanctify Myself, so that they also may be sanctified in truth.
- 20 *Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on me through their word;* I do not ask for these only, but also for those who will believe in Me through their word,
- 21 *That they all may be one; as thou, Father, art in me, and I in thee, that they also may be one in us: that the world may believe that thou hast sent me.* that they all may be one. Just as You, Father, are in Me and I in You, may they also be one in Us, so that the world may believe that You have sent Me.

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| <p>22 <i>And the glory which thou gavest me I have given them; that they may be one, even as we are one:</i></p> <p>23 <i>I in them, and thou in me, that they may be made perfect in one; and that the world may know that thou hast sent me, and hast loved them, as thou hast loved me.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Father, I will that they also, whom thou hast given me, be with me where I am; that they may behold my glory, which thou hast given me: for thou lovedst me before the foundation of the world.</i></p> <p>25 <i>O righteous Father, the world hath not known thee: but I have known thee, and these have known that thou hast sent me.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And I have declared unto them thy name, and will declare it: that the love wherewith thou hast loved me may be in them, and I in them.</i></p> | <p>The glory You have given Me I have given to them, so that they may be one, just as We are one —</p> <p>I in them, and You in Me — so that they may be perfected into one. Then the world will know that You sent Me and that You have loved them just as You have loved Me.</p> <p>Father, I desire that those You have given Me may also be with Me where I am, to see My glory, which You have given Me because You loved Me before the foundation of the world.</p> <p>Righteous Father, the world has not known You, but I have known You. These people know that You have sent Me.</p> <p>I have made Your name known to them, and I will continue to make it known, so that the love You have for Me may be in them, and I in them."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctify (*SANK-tih-fy*) — to set apart as holy; Jesus prays that the Father would sanctify His disciples through the truth

glory (*GLOR-ee*) — the visible radiance of God's presence and majesty; Jesus speaks of the glory He shared with the Father before the world began

Cross-References:

v1 — Phil 2:9-11; John 13:31-32; John 17:4-5; John 12:23; John 12:27-28

v2 — John 10:28-29; John 6:39; John 6:37; Dan 7:14; Matt 28:18

v3 — 1 John 5:20; 1 John 5:11-12; Jer 9:23-24; John 3:17; John 17:25

v5 — John 1:1-3; Col 1:15-17; 1 Pet 1:20; John 10:30; Phil 2:6

v9 — Heb 9:24; John 17:2; John 17:6; Luke 22:32; 1 John 2:1-2

v11 — Matt 6:9; Prov 18:10; John 17:12-18; John 10:29-30; Heb 9:24

v12 — Ps 109:6-19; John 10:27-28; John 18:9; John 13:18; John 6:37

v13 — Heb 12:2; Gal 5:22; John 15:11; John 3:29; John 16:22-24

v15 — Ps 121:7; 1 John 5:18; Matt 6:13; 2 Thess 3:3; 1 Chr 4:10

v17 — John 15:3; Ps 119:160; Eph 5:26; 1 Pet 1:22-23; John 17:19

v21 — 1 Cor 12:12; Col 3:11-14; John 17:11; 1 Cor 12:25-27; Phil 1:27

v24 — John 17:5; John 12:26; John 14:3; 2 Cor 4:6; 1 John 3:2

Chapter 18

Judas leads a band of soldiers to the Garden of Gethsemane, and Jesus is arrested after Peter cuts off the ear of the high priest's servant. Jesus is questioned before Annas and Caiaphas, and Peter denies Him three times. Jesus is brought before Pontius Pilate, who finds no fault in Him, but the crowd demands Barabbas.

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| 1 | <i>When Jesus had spoken these words, he went forth with his disciples over the brook Cedron, where was a garden, into the which he entered, and his disciples.</i> | When Jesus had said these things, He went out with His disciples across the brook Cedron, where there was a garden, and He and His disciples entered it. |
| 2 | <i>And Judas also, which betrayed him, knew the place: for Jesus oftentimes resorted thither with his disciples.</i> | Judas, who betrayed him, also knew the place, because Jesus had often met there with His disciples. |
| 3 | <i>Judas then, having received a band of men and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, cometh thither with lanterns and torches and weapons.</i> | So Judas, having obtained a band of soldiers and some officers from the chief priests and the Pharisees, came there with lanterns, torches, and weapons. |
| 4 | <i>Jesus therefore, knowing all things that should come upon him, went forth, and said unto them, Whom seek ye?</i> | Then Jesus, knowing all that was coming on Him, stepped forward and said to them, "Whom are You seeking?" |
| 5 | <i>They answered him, Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus saith unto them, I am he. And Judas also, which betrayed him, stood with them.</i> | They answered Him, "Jesus of Nazareth." Jesus said to them, "I am He." Judas, who betrayed him, was standing with them. |
| 6 | <i>As soon then as he had said unto them, I am he, they went backward, and fell to the ground.</i> | When He said to them, "I am He," they drew back and fell to the ground. |

- 7 *Then asked he them again, Whom seek ye? And they said, Jesus of Nazareth.* He asked them again, "Whom are You seeking?" And they said, "Jesus of Nazareth."
- 8 *Jesus answered, I have told you that I am he: if therefore ye seek me, let these go their way:* Jesus answered, "I told You that I am He. So if You are looking for Me, let these others go."
- 9 *That the saying might be fulfilled, which he spake, Of them which thou gavest me have I lost none.* This was to fulfill the word He had spoken: "Of those You gave Me, I have lost none."
- 10 *Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.* Then Simon Peter, who had a sword, drew it and struck the high priest's servant, cutting off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.
- 11 *Then said Jesus unto Peter, Put up thy sword into the sheath: the cup which my Father hath given me, shall I not drink it?* Jesus said to Peter, "Put your sword into its sheath. Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given Me?"
- 12 *Then the band and the captain and officers of the Jews took Jesus, and bound him,* So the band of soldiers, along with their commander and the officers of the Jews, seized Jesus and bound Him.
- 13 *And led him away to Annas first; for he was father in law to Caiaphas, which was the high priest that same year.* They led Him first to Annas, who was the father-in-law of Caiaphas, the high priest that year.
- 14 *Now Caiaphas was he, which gave counsel to the Jews, that it was expedient that one man should die for the people.* Caiaphas was the one who had advised the Jews that it was better for one man to die for the people.
- 15 *And Simon Peter followed Jesus, and so did another disciple: that disciple was known unto the high priest, and went in with Jesus into the palace of the high priest.* Simon Peter followed Jesus, and so did another disciple. That disciple was known to the high priest and entered the courtyard of the high priest with Jesus,

- 16 *But Peter stood at the door without. Then went out that other disciple, which was known unto the high priest, and spake unto her that kept the door, and brought in Peter.* but Peter stood outside at the door. The other disciple — the one known to the high priest — went out and spoke to the woman at the door and brought Peter in.
- 17 *Then saith the damsel that kept the door unto Peter, Art not thou also one of this man's disciples? He saith, I am not.* The servant woman at the door said to Peter, "Are you not also one of this man's disciples?" He said, "I am not."
- 18 *And the servants and officers stood there, who had made a fire of coals; for it was cold: and they warmed themselves: and Peter stood with them, and warmed himself.* Now the servants and officers had made a charcoal fire because it was cold, and they were standing and warming themselves. Peter also was standing with them and warming himself.
- 19 *The high priest then asked Jesus of his disciples, and of his doctrine.* The high priest questioned Jesus about His disciples and about His teaching.
- 20 *Jesus answered him, I spake openly to the world; I ever taught in the synagogue, and in the temple, whither the Jews always resort; and in secret have I said nothing.* Jesus answered Him, "I have spoken openly to the world. I always taught in the synagogues and in the temple, where all the Jews gather. I said nothing in secret.
- 21 *Why askest thou me? ask them which heard me, what I have said unto them: behold, they know what I said.* Why do You ask Me? Ask those who heard Me what I said to them. They know what I said."
- 22 *And when he had thus spoken, one of the officers which stood by struck Jesus with the palm of his hand, saying, Answerest thou the high priest so?* When He said this, one of the officers standing by struck Jesus with His hand, saying, "Is that how You answer the high priest?"
- 23 *Jesus answered him, If I have spoken evil, bear witness of the evil: but if well, why smitest thou me?* Jesus answered Him, "If I said something wrong, testify about the wrong. But if I spoke rightly, why do You strike Me?"

- 24 *Now Annas had sent him bound unto Caiaphas the high priest.* Then Annas sent Him bound to Caiaphas the high priest.
- 25 *And Simon Peter stood and warmed himself. They said therefore unto him, Art not thou also one of his disciples? He denied it, and said, I am not.* Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They said to him, "Are you not also one of His disciples?" He denied it and said, "I am not."
- 26 *One of the servants of the high priest, being his kinsman whose ear Peter cut off, saith, Did not I see thee in the garden with him?* One of the servants of the high priest — a relative of the man whose ear Peter had cut off — said, "Did I not see you in the garden with Him?"
- 27 *Peter then denied again: and immediately the cock crew.* Peter denied it again, and immediately the rooster crowed.
- 28 *Then led they Jesus from Caiaphas unto the hall of judgment: and it was early; and they themselves went not into the judgment hall, lest they should be defiled; but that they might eat the passover.* Then they led Jesus from Caiaphas to the governor's headquarters. It was early morning. They themselves did not enter the governor's headquarters, so that they would not be defiled but could eat the Passover.
- 29 *Pilate then went out unto them, and said, What accusation bring ye against this man?* So Pilate went out to them and said, "What accusation do you bring against this man?"
- 30 *They answered and said unto him, If he were not a malefactor, we would not have delivered him up unto thee.* They answered him, "If this man were not a criminal, we would not have handed Him over to you."
- 31 *Then said Pilate unto them, Take ye him, and judge him according to your law. The Jews therefore said unto him, It is not lawful for us to put any man to death:* Pilate said to them, "Take him yourselves and judge Him by your own law." The Jews said to him, "It is not lawful for us to put anyone to death."
- 32 *That the saying of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spake, signifying what death he should die.* This was to fulfill the word of Jesus, which He spoke to show what kind of death He would die.

- 33 *Then Pilate entered into the judgment hall again, and called Jesus, and said unto him, Art thou the King of the Jews?* So Pilate entered the headquarters again and called Jesus and said to Him, "Are You the King of the Jews?"
- 34 *Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me?* Jesus answered, "Do You say this on Your own, or did others tell You about Me?"
- 35 *Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done?* Pilate answered, "Am I a Jew? Your own nation and the chief priests have handed You over to me. What have You done?"
- 36 *Jesus answered, My kingdom is not of this world: if my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight, that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom not from hence.* Jesus answered, "My kingdom is not of this world. If My kingdom were of this world, My servants would have been fighting to keep Me from being handed over to the Jews. But My kingdom is not from here."
- 37 *Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice.* Pilate said to him, "So you are a king?" Jesus answered, "You say that I am a king. For this reason I was born, and for this reason I came into the world — to testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to My voice."
- 38 *Pilate saith unto him, What is truth? And when he had said this, he went out again unto the Jews, and saith unto them, I find in him no fault at all.* Pilate said to him, "What is truth?" After he said this, he went back out to the Jews and told them, "I find no fault in Him at all."
- 39 *But ye have a custom, that I should release unto you one at the passover: will ye therefore that I release unto you the King of the Jews?* But you have a custom that I should release one man for you at the Passover. So do you want me to release for you the King of the Jews?"
- 40 *Then cried they all again, saying, Not this man, but Barabbas. Now Barabbas was a robber.* They cried out again, "Not this man, but Barabbas!" Now Barabbas was a robber.

Words in this chapter:

Pilate (*PY-lat*) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Nazareth (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Sam 15:23; Mark 14:32; Matt 26:36; Luke 22:39-40; John 18:26

v6 — Ps 27:2; Ps 70:2-3; 2 Kgs 1:9-15

v9 — John 17:12

v10 — Mark 14:47; Matt 26:51-54; Luke 22:49-51; John 18:26

v11 — Matt 20:22; Matt 26:39; John 20:17; John 12:27-28; John 15:10

v15 — Mark 14:54; Luke 22:54

v20 — John 7:26; Isa 48:16; Matt 4:23; Luke 21:37; John 7:4

v28 — John 18:33; John 19:9; Mark 15:1-5; John 19:14; Matt 27:27

v32 — John 3:14; Matt 26:2; Matt 20:19; John 12:32-33; Luke 18:32-33

v36 — Luke 17:20-21; Col 1:12-14; Rom 14:17; John 6:15; Dan 7:14

v37 — 1 John 4:6; John 8:47; John 8:14; John 10:26-27; 1 John 3:19

v38 — John 19:4; John 19:6; Luke 23:4

Chapter 19

Pilate has Jesus scourged and the soldiers crown Him with thorns and mock Him. Pilate delivers Jesus to be crucified at Golgotha, where He is nailed to the cross between two others. Jesus commits His mother to John's care, declares 'It is finished,' and gives up His spirit. Joseph of Arimathaea and Nicodemus bury Him.

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| <p>¹ <i>Then Pilate therefore took Jesus, and scourged him.</i></p> | Then Pilate took Jesus and had Him flogged. |
| <p>² <i>And the soldiers platted a crown of thorns, and put it on his head, and they put on him a purple robe,</i></p> | The soldiers twisted together a crown of thorns and put it on His head. They dressed Him in a purple robe |
| <p>³ <i>And said, Hail, King of the Jews! and they smote him with their hands.</i></p> | and kept coming up to Him, saying, "Hail, King of the Jews!" They struck Him with their hands. |

- 4 *Pilate therefore went forth again, and saith unto them, Behold, I bring him forth to you, that ye may know that I find no fault in him.* Pilate went out again and said to them, "See, I am bringing Him out to you so that you may know that I find no fault in Him."
- 5 *Then came Jesus forth, wearing the crown of thorns, and the purple robe. And Pilate saith unto them, Behold the man!* So Jesus came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple robe. Pilate said to them, "Look at the man!"
- 6 *When the chief priests therefore and officers saw him, they cried out, saying, Crucify him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Take ye him, and crucify him: for I find no fault in him.* When the chief priests and the officers saw Him, they cried out, "Crucify Him! Crucify Him!" Pilate said to them, "Take him yourselves and crucify Him — I find no fault in Him."
- 7 *The Jews answered him, We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.* The Jews answered Him, "We have a law, and according to our law He ought to die, because He made Himself the Son of God."
- 8 *When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he was the more afraid;* When Pilate heard this, he was even more afraid.
- 9 *And went again into the judgment hall, and saith unto Jesus, Whence art thou? But Jesus gave him no answer.* He went back into the headquarters and said to Jesus, "Where are You from?" But Jesus gave Him no answer.
- 10 *Then saith Pilate unto him, Speakest thou not unto me? knowest thou not that I have power to crucify thee, and have power to release thee?* So Pilate said to him, "You will not speak to me? Do you not know that I have authority to release You and authority to crucify You?"
- 11 *Jesus answered, Thou couldest have no power at all against me, except it were given thee from above: therefore he that delivered me unto thee hath the greater sin.* Jesus answered, "You would have no authority over Me at all unless it had been given You from above. Therefore the one who handed Me over to you has the greater sin."

- 12 *And from thenceforth Pilate sought to release him: but the Jews cried out, saying, If thou let this man go, thou art not Caesar's friend: whosoever maketh himself a king speaketh against Caesar.* From then on Pilate sought to release him. But the Jews cried out, "If you release this man, you are not Caesar's friend. Whoever makes himself a king speaks against Caesar."
- 13 *When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he brought Jesus forth, and sat down in the judgment seat in a place that is called the Pavement, but in the Hebrew, Gabbatha.* When Pilate heard these words, he brought Jesus out and sat down on the judgment seat at a place called the Pavement — in the Hebrew, Gabbatha.
- 14 *And it was the preparation of the passover, and about the sixth hour: and he saith unto the Jews, Behold your King!* It was the day of Preparation for the Passover, about the sixth hour. He said to the Jews, "Look at Your King!"
- 15 *But they cried out, Away with him, away with him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Shall I crucify your King? The chief priests answered, We have no king but Caesar.* They cried out, "Away with Him! Away with Him! Crucify Him!" Pilate said to them, "Shall I crucify your King?" The chief priests answered, "We have no king but Caesar."
- 16 *Then delivered he him therefore unto them to be crucified. And they took Jesus, and led him away.* So He handed Him over to them to be crucified. They took Jesus,
- 17 *And he bearing his cross went forth into a place called the place of a skull, which is called in the Hebrew Golgotha:* and He went out, carrying His own cross, to the place called the Place of a Skull — in the Hebrew, Golgotha.
- 18 *Where they crucified him, and two other with him, on either side one, and Jesus in the midst.* There they crucified Him, along with two others, one on each side, with Jesus in the middle.
- 19 *And Pilate wrote a title, and put it on the cross. And the writing was, JESUS OF NAZARETH THE KING OF THE JEWS.* Pilate also wrote a title and put it on the cross. It read: JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS.

- 20 *This title then read many of the Jews: for the place where Jesus was crucified was nigh to the city: and it was written in Hebrew, and Greek, and Latin.* Many of the Jews read this title, because the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city. It was written in Hebrew, and Greek, and Latin.
- 21 *Then said the chief priests of the Jews to Pilate, Write not, The King of the Jews; but that he said, I am King of the Jews.* So the chief priests of the Jews said to Pilate, "Do not write, 'The King of the Jews;' but rather, 'This man said, I am King of the Jews.'"
- 22 *Pilate answered, What I have written I have written.* Pilate answered, "What I have written, I have written."
- 23 *Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took his garments, and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also his coat: now the coat was without seam, woven from the top throughout.* When the soldiers had crucified Jesus, they took His garments and divided them into four parts — one for each soldier. But His tunic was seamless, woven in one piece from top to bottom.
- 24 *They said therefore among themselves, Let us not rend it, but cast lots for it, whose it shall be: that the scripture might be fulfilled, which saith, They parted my raiment among them, and for my vesture they did cast lots. These things therefore the soldiers did.* So they said to one another, "Let us not tear it, but cast lots for it to see whose it will be." This was to fulfill the Scripture: "They divided My clothes among them, and for My clothing they cast lots." These things the soldiers did.
- 25 *Now there stood by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.* Standing by the cross of Jesus were His mother, His mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.
- 26 *When Jesus therefore saw his mother, and the disciple standing by, whom he loved, he saith unto his mother, Woman, behold thy son!* When Jesus saw His mother and the disciple whom he loved standing nearby, he said to His mother, "Woman, see Your son!"

- 27 *Then saith he to the disciple, Behold thy mother! And from that hour that disciple took her unto his own home.* Then He said to the disciple, "See your mother!" From that hour the disciple took her into his own home.
- 28 *After this, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, saith, I thirst.* After this, Jesus, knowing that all things were now finished, said — to fulfill the Scripture — "I am thirsty."
- 29 *Now there was set a vessel full of vinegar: and they filled a sponge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.* A jar full of sour wine was standing there. They put a sponge full of the sour wine on a hyssop branch and held it to His mouth.
- 30 *When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, It is finished: and he bowed his head, and gave up the ghost.* When Jesus had received the sour wine, He said, "It is finished." He bowed His head and gave up the ghost.
- 31 *The Jews therefore, because it was the preparation, that the bodies should not remain upon the cross on the sabbath day, (for that sabbath day was an high day,) sought Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away.* Since it was the day of Preparation, the Jews did not want the bodies left on the cross on the Sabbath — for that Sabbath was a high day — so they asked Pilate to have their legs broken and the bodies taken away.
- 32 *Then came the soldiers, and brake the legs of the first, and of the other which was crucified with him.* So the soldiers came and broke the legs of the first man and of the other who had been crucified with Him.
- 33 *But when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was dead already, they brake not his legs:* But when they came to Jesus and saw that He was already dead, they did not break His legs.
- 34 *But one of the soldiers with a spear pierced his side, and forthwith came there out blood and water.* Instead, one of the soldiers pierced His side with a spear, and at once blood and water came out.

- 35 *And he that saw it bare record, and his record is true: and he knoweth that he saith true, that ye might believe.* The one who saw this has testified, and his testimony is true. He knows He is telling the truth, so that You also may believe.
- 36 *For these things were done, that the scripture should be fulfilled, A bone of him shall not be broken.* These things happened so that the Scripture would be fulfilled: "Not one of His bones will be broken."
- 37 *And again another scripture saith, They shall look on him whom they pierced.* And again another Scripture says, "They will look on Him whom they pierced."
- 38 *And after this Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, besought Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus: and Pilate gave him leave. He came therefore, and took the body of Jesus.* After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea — who was a disciple of Jesus, but secretly, for fear of the Jews — asked Pilate for permission to take away the body of Jesus. Pilate gave him permission. So he came and took away Jesus' body.
- 39 *And there came also Nicodemus, which at the first came to Jesus by night, and brought a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about an hundred pound weight.* Nicodemus also came — the man who had first come to Jesus at night — bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred pounds.
- 40 *Then took they the body of Jesus, and wound it in linen clothes with the spices, as the manner of the Jews is to bury.* They took the body of Jesus and wrapped it in linen cloths with the spices, according to the Jewish burial custom.
- 41 *Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre, wherein was never man yet laid.* Now there was a garden in the place where He was crucified, and in the garden a new tomb in which no one had yet been laid.
- 42 *There laid they Jesus therefore because of the Jews' preparation day; for the sepulchre was nigh at hand.* So because of the Jewish day of Preparation, and since the tomb was nearby, they laid Jesus there.

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Golgotha (*GOL-gah-thah*) — The hill outside Jerusalem where Jesus was crucified — an Aramaic word meaning 'place of the skull'; called Calvary in Latin.

Cross-References:

- v7 — Lev 24:16; John 5:18; Matt 26:63-66; Rom 1:4; Mark 15:39
- v11 — Rom 13:1; John 3:27; Acts 2:23; Dan 4:17; Acts 3:13
- v24 — Ps 22:18; John 19:28; John 19:36-37
- v25 — Luke 23:49; Matt 27:55-56; John 20:1; Mark 15:40-41; John 20:11-18
- v26 — John 21:24; John 13:23; John 2:4; John 21:7; John 20:2
- v27 — Matt 12:48-50; John 16:32; 1 Tim 5:2-4; 1 John 3:18-19
- v28 — Ps 69:21; Ps 22:15; John 19:30; Luke 22:37; Luke 18:31
- v29 — Num 19:18; Luke 23:36; Mark 15:36; Matt 27:48; Ex 12:22
- v30 — John 17:4; Phil 2:8; Col 2:14-17; Heb 12:2; John 10:11
- v34 — 1 John 5:6; Zech 12:10; Zech 13:1; 1 John 5:8; Ezek 36:25
- v36 — Ps 34:20; Num 9:12; Ex 12:46; Ps 22:14; John 19:28
- v37 — Zech 12:10; Rev 1:7; Ps 22:16-17

Chapter 20

Mary Magdalene comes to the tomb early on the first day of the week and finds it empty. The risen Jesus appears to her, then to the disciples behind locked doors, showing them His hands and His side. Thomas, absent the first time, sees Jesus eight days later and confesses, 'My Lord and my God.'

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| 1 | <i>The first day of the week cometh Mary Magdalene early, when it was yet dark, unto the sepulchre, and seeth the stone taken away from the sepulchre.</i> | On the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene came to the tomb early, while it was still dark. She saw that the stone had been taken away from the tomb. |
| 2 | <i>Then she runneth, and cometh to Simon Peter, and to the other disciple, whom Jesus loved, and saith unto them, They have taken away the Lord out of the sepulchre, and we know not where they have laid him.</i> | She ran and went to Simon Peter and the other disciple — the one whom Jesus loved — and said to them, "They have taken the Lord out of the tomb, and we do not know where they have laid Him." |
| 3 | <i>Peter therefore went forth, and that other disciple, and came to the sepulchre.</i> | Peter went out, along with the other disciple, and they were going to the tomb. |

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| 4 <i>So they ran both together: and the other disciple did outrun Peter, and came first to the sepulchre.</i> | Both were running together, but the other disciple outran Peter and reached the tomb first. |
| 5 <i>And he stooping down, and looking in, saw the linen clothes lying; yet went he not in.</i> | Stooping and looking in, he saw the linen cloths lying there, but he did not go in. |
| 6 <i>Then cometh Simon Peter following him, and went into the sepulchre, and seeth the linen clothes lie,</i> | Then Simon Peter came, following him, and he went into the tomb. He saw the linen cloths lying there, |
| 7 <i>And the napkin, that was about his head, not lying with the linen clothes, but wrapped together in a place by itself.</i> | and the face cloth that had been on His head — not lying with the linen cloths, but folded up in a place by itself. |
| 8 <i>Then went in also that other disciple, which came first to the sepulchre, and he saw, and believed.</i> | Then the other disciple, who had reached the tomb first, also went in. He saw and believed. |
| 9 <i>For as yet they knew not the scripture, that he must rise again from the dead.</i> | For as yet they did not understand the Scripture, that He must rise from the dead. |
| 10 <i>Then the disciples went away again unto their own home.</i> | Then the disciples went back to their own homes. |
| 11 <i>But Mary stood without at the sepulchre weeping: and as she wept, she stooped down, and looked into the sepulchre,</i> | But Mary stood outside the tomb weeping. As she wept, she stooped and looked into the tomb. |
| 12 <i>And seeth two angels in white sitting, the one at the head, and the other at the feet, where the body of Jesus had lain.</i> | She saw two angels in white, sitting where the body of Jesus had lain — one at the head and one at the feet. |
| 13 <i>And they say unto her, Woman, why weepest thou? She saith unto them, Because they have taken away my Lord, and I know not where they have laid him.</i> | They said to her, "Woman, why are You weeping?" She said to them, "They have taken away my Lord, and I do not know where they have laid Him." |

- 14 *And when she had thus said, she turned herself back, and saw Jesus standing, and knew not that it was Jesus.* When she had said this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing, but she did not know it was Jesus.
- 15 *Jesus saith unto her, Woman, why weepest thou? whom seekest thou? She, supposing him to be the gardener, saith unto him, Sir, if thou have borne him hence, tell me where thou hast laid him, and I will take him away.* Jesus said to her, "Woman, why are You weeping? Whom are You seeking?" Thinking He was the gardener, she said to Him, "Sir, if You have carried Him away, tell me where You have laid Him, and I will take Him."
- 16 *Jesus saith unto her, Mary. She turned herself, and saith unto him, Rabboni; which is to say, Master.* Jesus said to her, "Mary." She turned and said to him, "Rabboni!" — which means Master.
- 17 *Jesus saith unto her, Touch me not; for I am not yet ascended to my Father: but go to my brethren, and say unto them, I ascend unto my Father, and your Father; and to my God, and your God.* Jesus said to her, "Do not hold on to Me, for I have not yet ascended to the Father. But go to My brothers and say to them, 'I am ascending to My Father and Your Father, and to My God and Your God.'"
- 18 *Mary Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had spoken these things unto her.* Mary Magdalene went and told the disciples, "I have seen the Lord" — and she told them what He had said to her.
- 19 *Then the same day at evening, being the first day of the week, when the doors were shut where the disciples were assembled for fear of the Jews, came Jesus and stood in the midst, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you.* On the evening of that first day of the week, when the doors were locked where the disciples were, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with You."
- 20 *And when he had so said, he shewed unto them his hands and his side. Then were the disciples glad, when they saw the Lord.* When He had said this, He showed them His hands and His side. The disciples were glad when they saw the Lord.

- 21 *Then said Jesus to them again, Peace be unto you: as my Father hath sent me, even so send I you.* Jesus said to them again, "Peace be with You. As the Father has sent Me, so I am sending You."
- 22 *And when he had said this, he breathed on them, and saith unto them, Receive ye the Holy Ghost:* When He had said this, He breathed on them and said, "Receive the Holy Ghost."
- 23 *Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; and whose soever sins ye retain, they are retained.* If You forgive the sins of anyone, they are forgiven. If you retain the sins of anyone, they are retained."
- 24 *But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, was not with them when Jesus came.* Now Thomas, one of the twelve — called Didymus — was not with them when Jesus came.
- 25 *The other disciples therefore said unto him, We have seen the Lord. But he said unto them, Except I shall see in his hands the print of the nails, and put my finger into the print of the nails, and thrust my hand into his side, I will not believe.* So the other disciples told Him, "We have seen the Lord." But He said to them, "Unless I see the nail marks in His hands, put my finger into the nail marks, and put my hand into His side, I will not believe."
- 26 *And after eight days again his disciples were within, and Thomas was with them: then came Jesus, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst, and said, Peace be unto you.* Eight days later, His disciples were inside again, and Thomas was with them. The doors were locked, but Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with You."
- 27 *Then saith he to Thomas, Reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands; and reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side: and be not faithless, but believing.* Then He said to Thomas, "Put your finger here, and see My hands. Reach out your hand and put it into My side. Do not be faithless, but believing."
- 28 *And Thomas answered and said unto him, My Lord and my God.* Thomas answered him, "My Lord and my God!"

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| <p>29 <i>Jesus saith unto him, Thomas, because thou hast seen me, thou hast believed: blessed are they that have not seen, and yet have believed.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And many other signs truly did Jesus in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book:</i></p> <p>31 <i>But these are written, that ye might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing ye might have life through his name.</i></p> | <p>Jesus said to Him, "Because You have seen Me, You have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed."</p> <p>Jesus performed many other signs in the presence of His disciples that are not written in this book.</p> <p>But these are written so that You may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that by believing You may have life in His name.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Rabboni (*rab-OH-nee*) — Aramaic for 'My great Teacher' — a more reverent form of Rabbi, used by Mary to address the risen Christ.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Mark 16:9; Matt 27:60; Mark 15:46; Luke 24:1-10; John 19:25
- v9 — Ps 16:10; Isa 25:8; Isa 53:10-12; Luke 24:44-46; Isa 26:19
- v14 — Luke 24:16; Song 3:3-4; Matt 28:9; Mark 16:9; John 21:4
- v17 — John 16:28; Eph 4:8-10; Gal 4:6-7; 1 Pet 1:3; John 17:11
- v19 — John 20:26; John 14:27; Luke 24:36-49; John 20:21; Eph 2:14
- v21 — John 17:18-19; Matt 28:18-20; John 13:20; John 3:17; Mark 16:15-18
- v22 — Job 33:4; Gen 2:7; John 7:39; Acts 2:38; Acts 8:15
- v23 — Matt 18:18; Matt 16:19; Mark 2:5-10; Acts 13:38-39; Acts 10:43
- v28 — John 1:1; Isa 9:6; 1 Tim 3:16; Isa 7:14; Matt 14:33
- v29 — 1 Pet 1:8; 2 Cor 5:7; Heb 11:1; Heb 11:27; Luke 1:45
- v30 — John 21:25; Rom 15:4; 1 John 5:13; 2 Tim 3:15-17; John 2:11
- v31 — Acts 10:43; John 3:15-16; 1 John 5:1; 1 John 4:15; John 3:36

Chapter 21

The risen Jesus appears to seven disciples at the Sea of Tiberias and directs them to a miraculous catch of 153 fish. He restores Peter with three questions — 'Do you love Me?' — and commissions him to feed His sheep. Jesus foretells Peter's death and speaks concerning the beloved disciple.

- 1 *After these things Jesus shewed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias; and on this wise shewed he himself.* After this, Jesus revealed Himself again to the disciples at the Sea of Tiberias. He revealed Himself in this way.
- 2 *There were together Simon Peter, and Thomas called Didymus, and Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two other of his disciples.* Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus, Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, the sons of Zebedee, and two other of His disciples were together.
- 3 *Simon Peter saith unto them, I go a fishing. They say unto him, We also go with thee. They went forth, and entered into a ship immediately; and that night they caught nothing.* Simon Peter said to them, "I am going fishing." They said to him, "We will go with you." They went out and got into the boat, but that night they caught nothing.
- 4 *But when the morning was now come, Jesus stood on the shore: but the disciples knew not that it was Jesus.* Just as day was breaking, Jesus stood on the shore. Yet the disciples did not know it was Jesus.
- 5 *Then Jesus saith unto them, Children, have ye any meat? They answered him, No.* Jesus said to them, "Children, have You caught any fish?" They answered Him, "No."
- 6 *And he said unto them, Cast the net on the right side of the ship, and ye shall find. They cast therefore, and now they were not able to draw it for the multitude of fishes.* He said to them, "Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and You will find some." So they cast it, and now they were not able to haul it in because of the great number of fish.
- 7 *Therefore that disciple whom Jesus loved saith unto Peter, It is the Lord. Now when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he girt his fisher's coat unto him, (for he was naked,) and did cast himself into the sea.* That disciple whom Jesus loved said to Peter, "It is the Lord!" When Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he put on his outer garment — for he was stripped for work — and threw himself into the sea.
- 8 *And the other disciples came in a little ship; (for they were not far from land, but as it were two hundred cubits,) dragging the net with fishes.* The other disciples came in the boat, dragging the net full of fish, for they were not far from land — only about a hundred yards.

- 9 *As soon then as they were come to land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid thereon, and bread.* When they got out on land, they saw a charcoal fire in place, with fish laid on it and bread.
- 10 *Jesus saith unto them, Bring of the fish which ye have now caught.* Jesus said to them, "Bring some of the fish You have just caught."
- 11 *Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land full of great fishes, an hundred and fifty and three: and for all there were so many, yet was not the net broken.* So Simon Peter went and hauled the net ashore, full of large fish — a hundred and fifty-three of them. Even though there were so many, the net was not torn.
- 12 *Jesus saith unto them, Come and dine. And none of the disciples durst ask him, Who art thou? knowing that it was the Lord.* Jesus said to them, "Come and have breakfast." None of the disciples dared ask Him, "Who are You?" They knew it was the Lord.
- 13 *Jesus then cometh, and taketh bread, and giveth them, and fish likewise.* Jesus came and took the bread and gave it to them, and so with the fish.
- 14 *This is now the third time that Jesus shewed himself to his disciples, after that he was risen from the dead.* This was now the third time that Jesus revealed Himself to the disciples after He had risen from the dead.
- 15 *So when they had dined, Jesus saith to Simon Peter, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me more than these? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my lambs.* When they had eaten breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, "Simon, son of Jonas, do you love Me more than these?" He said to Him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I love You." He said to Him, "Feed My lambs."
- 16 *He saith to him again the second time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my sheep.* He said to Him again a second time, "Simon, son of Jonas, do you love Me?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; You know that I love You." He said to Him, "Tend My sheep."

- 17 *He saith unto him the third time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he said unto him the third time, Lovest thou me? And he said unto him, Lord, thou knowest all things; thou knowest that I love thee. Jesus saith unto him, Feed my sheep.* He said to Him the third time, "Simon, son of Jonas, do you love Me?" Peter was grieved because he said to him the third time, "Do You love Me?" He said to Him, "Lord, You know all things. You know that I love You." Jesus said to Him, "Feed My sheep.
- 18 *Verily, verily, I say unto thee, When thou wast young, thou girdedst thyself, and walkedst whither thou wouldest: but when thou shalt be old, thou shalt stretch forth thy hands, and another shall gird thee, and carry thee whither thou wouldest not.* Truly, truly, I say to You, when You were young, You used to dress Yourself and go wherever You wanted. But when You are old, You will stretch out Your hands and another will dress You and carry You where You do not want to go."
- 19 *This spake he, signifying by what death he should glorify God. And when he had spoken this, he saith unto him, Follow me.* He said this to show by what kind of death Peter would glorify God. After saying this, He said to Him, "Follow Me."
- 20 *Then Peter, turning about, seeth the disciple whom Jesus loved following; which also leaned on his breast at supper, and said, Lord, which is he that betrayeth thee?* Peter turned and saw the disciple whom Jesus loved following — the one who had also leaned against him at supper and had said, "Lord, who is it that will betray You?"
- 21 *Peter seeing him saith to Jesus, Lord, and what shall this man do?* When Peter saw him, he said to Jesus, "Lord, what about this man?"
- 22 *Jesus saith unto him, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee? follow thou me.* Jesus said to Him, "If I want Him to wait until I come, what is that to You? You follow Me."
- 23 *Then went this saying abroad among the brethren, that that disciple should not die: yet Jesus said not unto him, He shall not die; but, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?* So this word spread among the brothers that that disciple would not die. Yet Jesus had not said to Him that He would not die, but, "If I want Him to wait until I come, what is that to You?"

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| <p>24 <i>This is the disciple which testifieth of these things, and wrote these things: and we know that his testimony is true.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And there are also many other things which Jesus did, the which, if they should be written every one, I suppose that even the world itself could not contain the books that should be written. Amen.</i></p> | <p>This is the disciple who testifies about these things and who wrote these things down. We know that his testimony is true.</p> <p>There are also many other things that Jesus did. If every one of them were written down, I suppose that even the world itself could not contain the books that would need to be written. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Luke 5:5; Matt 4:18-20; 2 Thess 3:7-9; Luke 5:10-11
- v5 — Phil 4:19
- v6 — Luke 5:4-7; Acts 2:41
- v12 — Acts 10:41
- v15 — Isa 40:11; 1 John 4:19; Rom 15:1; 2 Cor 5:14-15; 1 Pet 5:1-4
- v16 — Acts 20:28; 1 Pet 5:2; 1 Pet 2:25
- v17 — John 13:38; John 16:30; Mark 14:72
- v18 — John 13:36; Acts 12:3-4
- v19 — 2 Pet 1:14; John 21:22; Matt 10:38
- v22 — Rev 2:25; Rev 3:11; Mark 9:1
- v24 — John 15:27; John 19:35
- v25 — Ps 40:5; John 20:30-31; Ps 71:15; Job 26:14; Heb 11:32

Acts

Author: Luke, the physician — Acts is the direct sequel to the Gospel of Luke, addressed to the same Theophilus and continuing the narrative from the ascension of Christ.

Date written: c. AD 62, ending abruptly with Paul under house arrest in Rome — a natural stopping point if Luke wrote before Paul's trial concluded.

Written to: Theophilus and the wider Gentile world, to provide an orderly account of the gospel's spread from Jerusalem to Rome.

Setting: The risen Christ has ascended. Fifty days later the Holy Spirit falls on the gathered disciples. Acts traces the next thirty years — from that upper room in Jerusalem to Paul in chains in the capital of the empire.

Where this sits historically: Spans the reigns of Tiberius, Caligula, Claudius, and Nero (c. AD 30–62), ending with Paul under house arrest in Nero's Rome before the persecutions that followed the Great Fire of AD 64.

Contemporaries: Paul wrote most of his epistles (Galatians through Romans, and the prison letters) during the events Acts narrates, while Peter, James, Barnabas, Silas, Timothy, and Apollos all played active roles in the spreading church.

Big themes:

- The Holy Spirit — He is the book's main actor; the Spirit empowers, directs, corrects, and sends throughout; Acts cannot be understood apart from Pentecost
- The gospel to all nations — Acts traces the exact progression Jesus promised: "Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth" (1:8)
- The church is born — Acts records the first sermons, the first converts, the first persecution, the first Gentile believers, and the first missionary journeys
- Peter and Paul — the book divides roughly in half between Peter's ministry (chs. 1–12) and Paul's three missionary journeys and arrest (chs. 13–28)
- Persecution and growth — the church does not grow despite persecution; it often grows through it; every attempt to stop the gospel accelerates it

Key passages: Acts 1:8; 2:38; 4:12; 8:37; 17:31

How it fits: Acts is the hinge between the Gospels and the Epistles. It explains how the church got from a room in Jerusalem to congregations in Corinth, Ephesus, Rome, and beyond. Every Pauline epistle was written to churches or people mentioned in Acts. Without Acts, the NT letters float without their historical anchor.

Pauline epistles tied to Acts:

| Letter | Date | Acts moment |

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| James | c. AD 45–49 | Before the Jerusalem Council (Acts 15) |

Galatians	c. AD 48–49	*Around the Jerusalem Council (Acts 15)*
1 Thessalonians	c. AD 50–51	*Second missionary journey, from Corinth (Acts 17–18)*
2 Thessalonians	c. AD 51–52	*Shortly after 1 Thessalonians (Acts 18)*
1 Corinthians	c. AD 55	*Third journey, from Ephesus (Acts 19)*
2 Corinthians	c. AD 56	*From Macedonia, after leaving Ephesus (Acts 20)*
Romans	c. AD 57	*End of third journey, from Corinth (Acts 20)*
Ephesians	c. AD 60–62	*Roman house arrest (Acts 28)*
Philippians	c. AD 60–62	*Roman house arrest (Acts 28)*
Colossians	c. AD 60–62	*Roman house arrest (Acts 28)*
Philemon	c. AD 60–62	*Roman house arrest (Acts 28)*

Chapter 1

Jesus commanded His apostles to wait in Jerusalem for the promise of the Holy Ghost, then ascended into heaven from the Mount of Olives. The disciples returned to Jerusalem, continued in prayer, and chose Matthias to replace Judas as the twelfth apostle.

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| 1 | <i>The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach,</i> | In my first book, Theophilus, I wrote about everything Jesus began to do and to teach, |
| 2 | <i>Until the day in which he was taken up, after that he through the Holy Ghost had given commandments unto the apostles whom he had chosen:</i> | up to the day He was taken up into heaven. Before that, through the Holy Ghost, He had given instructions to the apostles He had chosen. |
| 3 | <i>To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion by many infallible proofs, being seen of them forty days, and speaking of the things pertaining to the kingdom of God:</i> | After His suffering, He showed Himself to them and gave many convincing proofs that He was alive. He appeared to them over a period of forty days and spoke about the kingdom of God. |
| 4 | <i>And, being assembled together with them, commanded them that they should not depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which, saith he, ye have heard of me.</i> | While He was with them, He commanded them not to leave Jerusalem. "Wait for the gift My Father promised," He said, "which You have heard Me speak about." |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. The word "Ghost" here is an older English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is fully God, co-equal with the Father and the Son.*

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| 5 | <i>For John truly baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost not many days hence.</i> | "John baptized with water, but in a few days you will be baptized with the Holy Ghost." |
| 6 | <i>When they therefore were come together, they asked of him, saying, Lord, wilt thou at this time restore again the kingdom to Israel?</i> | When they came together, they asked Him, "Lord, will You restore the kingdom to Israel at this time?" |
| 7 | <i>And he said unto them, It is not for you to know the times or the seasons, which the Father hath put in his own power.</i> | He said to them, "It is not for You to know the times or dates the Father has set by His own authority." |
| 8 | <i>But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.</i> | "But You will receive power when the Holy Ghost comes on You. You will be My witnesses in Jerusalem, in all Judaea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth." |
| 9 | <i>And when he had spoken these things, while they beheld, he was taken up; and a cloud received him out of their sight.</i> | After He said this, He was taken up before their very eyes. A cloud hid Him from their sight. |
| 10 | <i>And while they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, two men stood by them in white apparel;</i> | They were looking intently up into the sky as He was going, when suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. |
| 11 | <i>Which also said, Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven? this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.</i> | "Men of Galilee," they said, "why do You stand here looking into the sky? This same Jesus, Who has been taken from You into heaven, will come back in the same way You have seen Him go into heaven." |

- 12 *Then returned they unto Jerusalem from the mount called Olivet, which is from Jerusalem a sabbath day's journey.* Then they returned to Jerusalem from the hill called the Mount of Olives, which is about a sabbath day's walk from the city.
- 13 *And when they were come in, they went up into an upper room, where abode both Peter, and James, and John, and Andrew, Philip, and Thomas, Bartholomew, and Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon Zelotes, and Judas the brother of James.* When they arrived, they went upstairs to the room where they were staying. Those present were Peter, James, John, Andrew, Philip, Thomas, Bartholomew, Matthew, James son of Alphaeus, Simon the Zealot, and Judas son of James.
- 14 *These all continued with one accord in prayer and supplication, with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brethren.* They all joined together constantly in prayer, along with the women, Mary the mother of Jesus, and His brothers.
- 15 *And in those days Peter stood up in the midst of the disciples, and said, (the number of names together were about an hundred and twenty,)* In those days Peter stood up among the believers — a group of about a hundred and twenty —
- 16 *Men and brethren, this scripture must needs have been fulfilled, which the Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake before concerning Judas, which was guide to them that took Jesus.* and said, "Brothers, the Scripture had to be fulfilled which the Holy Ghost spoke long ago through David concerning Judas, who served as guide for those who arrested Jesus."
- 17 *For he was numbered with us, and had obtained part of this ministry.* He was one of our number and shared in this ministry.
- 18 *Now this man purchased a field with the reward of iniquity; and falling headlong, he burst asunder in the midst, and all his bowels gushed out.* With the payment he received for his wickedness, Judas bought a field. There he fell headlong, his body burst open, and all his insides spilled out.

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Iniquity* (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin." Iniquity points to the corruption beneath the sinful act itself — the bent nature that produces evil deeds.

- 19 *And it was known unto all the dwellers at Jerusalem; insomuch as that field is called in their proper tongue, Aceldama, that is to say, The field of blood.* Everyone in Jerusalem heard about this, so that field is called in their language Aceldama, that is, Field of Blood.
- 20 *For it is written in the book of Psalms, Let his habitation be desolate, and let no man dwell therein: and his bishoprick let another take.* "For," said Peter, "it is written in the book of Psalms: 'May his place be deserted; let there be no one to dwell in it,' and, 'May another take his place of leadership.'"
- 21 *Wherefore of these men which have companied with us all the time that the Lord Jesus went in and out among us,* "Therefore it is necessary to choose one of the men who have been with us the whole time the Lord Jesus was with us,
- 22 *Beginning from the baptism of John, unto that same day that he was taken up from us, must one be ordained to be a witness with us of his resurrection.* beginning from John's baptism to the time when Jesus was taken up from us. One of these must become a witness with us of His resurrection."
- 23 *And they appointed two, Joseph called Barsabas, who was surnamed Justus, and Matthias.* They put forward two men: Joseph called Barsabas, also known as Justus, and Matthias.
- 24 *And they prayed, and said, Thou, Lord, which knowest the hearts of all men, shew whether of these two thou hast chosen,* Then they prayed, "Lord, You know everyone's heart. Show us which of these two You have chosen
- 25 *That he may take part of this ministry and apostleship, from which Judas by transgression fell, that he might go to his own place.* to take over this apostolic ministry, which Judas left to go where he belongs."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — crossing the line that God has set; breaking a specific command. Where "sin" is missing the mark, "transgression" is deliberately stepping over a known boundary.

- 26 *And they gave forth their lots; and the lot fell upon Matthias; and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.* Then they cast lots, and the lot fell to Matthias. He was added to the eleven apostles.

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 1:3; Luke 24:19; Matt 4:23-24; Luke 3:23; Matt 11:5
- v3 — 1 Cor 15:5-7; Acts 13:31; John 20:26; 1 John 1:1; John 21:14
- v4 — Luke 24:49; John 14:16; John 15:26; John 14:26-28; Acts 2:33
- v5 — Matt 3:11; Acts 11:15-16; Luke 3:16; 1 Cor 12:13; Titus 3:5
- v6 — Luke 19:11; Luke 17:20; Dan 7:27; Matt 24:3; Ezek 37:24-27
- v7 — Matt 24:36; 1 Thess 5:1-2; Mark 13:32; Deut 29:29; Mark 10:40
- v8 — Matt 28:19; Mark 16:15; Rom 15:19; Acts 4:33; Acts 5:32
- v9 — Dan 7:13; Luke 24:50-51; Mark 16:19; Eph 4:8-12; Acts 1:2
- v11 — Rev 1:7; 1 Thess 4:16; Mark 13:26; John 14:3; Matt 24:30
- v14 — Acts 6:4; Eph 6:18; Acts 2:42; Col 4:2; Rom 12:12
- v16 — Ps 41:9; John 13:18; Ps 55:12-15; Acts 1:20; John 12:38-40
- v20 — Ps 69:25; Ps 109:8-15; Acts 1:25

Chapter 2

The Holy Ghost fell on the day of Pentecost, and the apostles spoke in tongues as the Spirit gave them utterance. Peter preached to the crowd, proclaiming the resurrection of Christ, and about three thousand souls were baptized and added to the church.

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| 1 | <i>And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place.</i> | When the day of Pentecost arrived, they were all together in one place. |
| 2 | <i>And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting.</i> | Suddenly a sound like a violent rushing wind came from heaven and filled the whole house where they were sitting. |
| 3 | <i>And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them.</i> | They saw what appeared to be tongues of fire that separated and came to rest on each of them. |
| 4 | <i>And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.</i> | All of them were filled with the Holy Ghost and began to speak in other languages as the Spirit gave them the ability. |
| 5 | <i>And there were dwelling at Jerusalem Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven.</i> | Now there were living in Jerusalem devout Jews from every nation under heaven. |
| 6 | <i>Now when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded, because that every man heard them speak in his own language.</i> | When this sound was heard, a crowd gathered in confusion, because each one heard them speaking in his own language. |
| 7 | <i>And they were all amazed and marvelled, saying one to another, Behold, are not all these which speak Galilaeans?</i> | Amazed and astonished, they asked, "Aren't all these who are speaking Galileans?" |
| 8 | <i>And how hear we every man in our own tongue, wherein we were born?</i> | "Then how is it that each of us hears them in our own native language?" |
| 9 | <i>Parthians, and Medes, and Elamites, and the dwellers in Mesopotamia, and in Judaea, and Cappadocia, in Pontus, and Asia,</i> | "Parthians, Medes, and Elamites; people from Mesopotamia, Judaea, and Cappadocia; from Pontus and Asia, |

- 10 *Phrygia, and Pamphylia, in Egypt, and in the parts of Libya about Cyrene, and strangers of Rome, Jews and proselytes,* from Phrygia and Pamphylia; from Egypt and the parts of Libya near Cyrene; visitors from Rome, both Jews and converts to Judaism;
- 11 *Cretes and Arabians, we do hear them speak in our tongues the wonderful works of God.* Cretans and Arabians — we hear them declaring the wonders of God in our own languages!"
- 12 *And they were all amazed, and were in doubt, saying one to another, What meaneth this?* They were all amazed and perplexed. "What does this mean?" they asked one another.
- 13 *Others mocking said, These men are full of new wine.* But others mocked them and said, "They have had too much wine."
- 14 *But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words:* Then Peter stood up with the eleven, raised his voice, and addressed the crowd: "Fellow Jews and all who live in Jerusalem, listen carefully and let me explain this to you."
- 15 *For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day.* "These people are not drunk, as you suppose. It is only nine in the morning."
- 16 *But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel;* "No, this is what was spoken by the prophet Joel:"
- 17 *And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams:* "'In the last days, God says, I will pour out My Spirit on all flesh. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams."
- 18 *And on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy:* "'On My servants, both men and women, I will pour out My Spirit in those days, and they will prophesy."

- 19 *And I will shew wonders in heaven above, and signs in the earth beneath; blood, and fire, and vapour of smoke:* "I will show wonders in the heavens above and signs on the earth below — blood and fire and billows of smoke."
- 20 *The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before that great and notable day of the Lord come:* "'The sun will be turned to darkness and the moon to blood before the coming of the great and glorious day of the Lord.'"
- 21 *And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.* "And everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved."
- 22 *Ye men of Israel, hear these words; Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs, which God did by him in the midst of you, as ye yourselves also know:* "Men of Israel, listen to this: Jesus of Nazareth was a man accredited by God to You through miracles, wonders, and signs, which God did among You through Him, as You yourselves know."
- 23 *Him, being delivered by the determinate counsel and foreknowledge of God, ye have taken, and by wicked hands have crucified and slain:* "This man was handed over to you by God's set purpose and foreknowledge, and you, with the help of wicked men, put Him to death by nailing Him to the cross."
- 24 *Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the pains of death: because it was not possible that he should be holden of it.* "But God raised him from the dead, freeing Him from the agony of death, because it was impossible for death to keep its hold on Him."
- 25 *For David speaketh concerning him, I foresaw the Lord always before my face, for he is on my right hand, that I should not be moved:* "David said about him: 'I saw the Lord always before me. Because He is at my right hand, I will not be shaken.'"
- 26 *Therefore did my heart rejoice, and my tongue was glad; moreover also my flesh shall rest in hope:* "'Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body also will rest in hope,'"

- 27 *Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell, neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.* "because You will not abandon me to hell, nor will You let Your Holy One see decay."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — the place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one English word — "hell" — to translate several Hebrew and Greek words (Sheol, Hades, Gehenna). In Acts 2:27, it refers to the place of the departed, from which God did not allow Christ to remain.

- 28 *Thou hast made known to me the ways of life; thou shalt make me full of joy with thy countenance.* "You have made known to me the paths of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence."
- 29 *Men and brethren, let me freely speak unto you of the patriarch David, that he is both dead and buried, and his sepulchre is with us unto this day.* "Brothers, I can tell you confidently that the patriarch David died and was buried, and his tomb is here to this day."
- 30 *Therefore being a prophet, and knowing that God had sworn with an oath to him, that of the fruit of his loins, according to the flesh, he would raise up Christ to sit on his throne;* "But David was a prophet and knew that God had promised Him on oath that of the fruit of His loins, according to the flesh, He would raise up Christ to sit on His throne."
- 31 *He seeing this before spake of the resurrection of Christ, that his soul was not left in hell, neither his flesh did see corruption.* "Seeing what was to come, David spoke of the resurrection of Christ: that He was not abandoned to hell, nor did His body see decay."
- 32 *This Jesus hath God raised up, whereof we all are witnesses.* "God has raised this Jesus to life, and we are all witnesses of it."
- 33 *Therefore being by the right hand of God exalted, and having received of the Father the promise of the Holy Ghost, he hath shed forth this, which ye now see and hear.* "Exalted to the right hand of God, He has received from the Father the promised Holy Ghost and has poured out what You now see and hear."
- 34 *For David is not ascended into the heavens: but he saith himself, The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand,* "For David did not ascend to heaven, and yet he said, 'The LORD said to my Lord: Sit at My right hand

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| 35 <i>Until I make thy foes thy footstool.</i> | until I make Your enemies a footstool for Your feet." |
| 36 <i>Therefore let all the house of Israel know assuredly, that God hath made that same Jesus, whom ye have crucified, both Lord and Christ.</i> | "Therefore let all Israel be certain of this: God has made this Jesus, whom You crucified, both Lord and Christ." |
| 37 <i>Now when they heard this, they were pricked in their heart, and said unto Peter and to the rest of the apostles, Men and brethren, what shall we do?</i> | When the people heard this, they were cut to the heart and said to Peter and the other apostles, "Brothers, what shall we do?" |
| 38 <i>Then Peter said unto them, Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.</i> | Peter replied, "Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of Your sins. You will receive the gift of the Holy Ghost." |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve or earn. Grace is not a reward for good behavior — it is God freely giving what we do not merit because of His love.*

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| 39 <i>For the promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off, even as many as the Lord our God shall call.</i> | "The promise is for You and Your children and for all who are far off — for all whom the Lord our God will call." |
| 40 <i>And with many other words did he testify and exhort, saying, Save yourselves from this untoward generation.</i> | With many other words He warned them and urged them, "Save yourselves from this corrupt generation." |
| 41 <i>Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.</i> | Those who accepted His message were baptized, and about three thousand people were added to their number that day. |
| 42 <i>And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.</i> | They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching, to fellowship, to the breaking of bread, and to prayer. |

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| 43 | <i>And fear came upon every soul: and many wonders and signs were done by the apostles.</i> | Everyone was filled with awe, and the apostles performed many wonders and signs. |
| 44 | <i>And all that believed were together, and had all things common;</i> | All the believers were together and shared everything they had. |
| 45 | <i>And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.</i> | They sold property and possessions to give to anyone who had need. |
| 46 | <i>And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart,</i> | Every day they met together in the temple courts. They broke bread in their homes and ate together with glad and sincere hearts, |
| 47 | <i>Praising God, and having favour with all the people. And the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.</i> | praising God and enjoying the goodwill of all the people. And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved. |

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Pentecost (*PEN-teh-cost*) — The Feast of Weeks — celebrated fifty days after Passover; the harvest festival; in the NT, the day the Holy Spirit came on the early church.

Nazareth (*NAZ-ah-reth*) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Rome (*ROME*) — Capital of the Roman Empire — Paul wrote his letter to the Romans to the church there; he was eventually imprisoned and martyred in Rome.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rom 15:6; Phil 2:2; Acts 1:13-15; Phil 1:27; 1 Cor 16:8

v2 — Acts 4:31; 1 Kgs 19:11; John 3:8; Ps 18:10; Acts 16:25-26

v4 — Mark 16:17; Acts 13:52; Acts 4:31; Eph 5:18; 1 Cor 12:10

v17 — Joel 2:28-32; Isa 44:3; Titus 3:4-6; Acts 10:45; John 7:39

v21 — Rom 10:12-13; Joel 2:32; Ps 86:5; Acts 22:16; Heb 4:16

v24 — 1 Cor 6:14; Acts 2:32; 1 Pet 1:21; Rom 8:11; Col 2:12
 v25 — Ps 16:8-11; Isa 41:13; Ps 62:6; Ps 109:31; Isa 50:7-9
 v38 — Acts 22:16; Mark 16:16; Acts 8:12; Luke 24:47; Acts 3:19
 v39 — Isa 44:3; Gen 17:7-8; Rom 8:30; Joel 2:32; Eph 4:4
 v42 — Heb 10:25; Acts 1:14; 1 John 1:3; Acts 2:46; 1 John 1:7
 v46 — Acts 5:42; Acts 2:42; Ps 86:11; Acts 20:7; 2 Cor 1:12
 v47 — Acts 16:5; Acts 5:13-14; Acts 2:41; 1 Cor 1:18; Acts 2:39

Chapter 3

Peter healed a man lame from birth at the temple gate called Beautiful, commanding him to walk in the name of Jesus Christ. He then preached to the astonished crowd, calling them to repentance and declaring Jesus as the promised prophet spoken of by Moses.

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| 1 | <i>Now Peter and John went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour.</i> | One day Peter and John were going up to the temple at the time of prayer — at three in the afternoon. |
| 2 | <i>And a certain man lame from his mother's womb was carried, whom they laid daily at the gate of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask alms of them that entered into the temple;</i> | A man crippled from birth was being carried to the temple gate called Beautiful, where he was put every day to beg from those going into the temple. |
| 3 | <i>Who seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple asked an alms.</i> | When he saw Peter and John about to enter, he asked them for money. |
| 4 | <i>And Peter, fastening his eyes upon him with John, said, Look on us.</i> | Peter looked straight at him, and so did John. "Look at us," Peter said. |
| 5 | <i>And he gave heed unto them, expecting to receive something of them.</i> | So the man gave them his attention, expecting to get something from them. |
| 6 | <i>Then Peter said, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk.</i> | Then Peter said, "Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give You. In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk." |
| 7 | <i>And he took him by the right hand, and lifted him up: and immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength.</i> | Taking him by the right hand, he helped him up. At once the man's feet and ankles became strong. |

- 8 *And he leaping up stood, and walked, and entered with them into the temple, walking, and leaping, and praising God.* He jumped to his feet and began to walk. He went with them into the temple courts, walking and jumping and praising God.
- 9 *And all the people saw him walking and praising God:* When all the people saw him walking and praising God,
- 10 *And they knew that it was he which sat for alms at the Beautiful gate of the temple: and they were filled with wonder and amazement at that which had happened unto him.* they recognized him as the same man who used to sit begging at the Beautiful Gate. They were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him.
- 11 *And as the lame man which was healed held Peter and John, all the people ran together unto them in the porch that is called Solomon's, greatly wondering.* While the man held on to Peter and John, all the people came running to them at the place called Solomon's Porch, utterly astonished.
- 12 *And when Peter saw it, he answered unto the people, Ye men of Israel, why marvel ye at this? or why look ye so earnestly on us, as though by our own power or holiness we had made this man to walk?* When Peter saw this, he said to them, "Men of Israel, why does this surprise you? Why do you stare at us as if we had made this man walk by our own power or godliness?"
- 13 *The God of Abraham, and of Isaac, and of Jacob, the God of our fathers, hath glorified his Son Jesus; whom ye delivered up, and denied him in the presence of Pilate, when he was determined to let him go.* "The God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob — the God of our fathers — has glorified His Son Jesus. You handed Him over to be killed and denied Him before Pilate, even though he had decided to let him go."
- 14 *But ye denied the Holy One and the Just, and desired a murderer to be granted unto you;* "You denied the Holy and Righteous One and asked that a murderer be released to You."
- 15 *And killed the Prince of life, whom God hath raised from the dead; whereof we are witnesses.* "You killed the author of life, but God raised Him from the dead. We are witnesses of this."

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| <p>16 <i>And his name through faith in his name hath made this man strong, whom ye see and know: yea, the faith which is by him hath given him this perfect soundness in the presence of you all.</i></p> | <p>"By faith in the name of Jesus, this man whom you see and know was made strong. It is Jesus' name and the faith that comes through Him that has completely healed Him, as You can all see."</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Faith** (FAYTH) — *trust and confidence placed in God and His Word. Faith is not merely believing facts — it is personally relying on God, taking Him at His word, and acting on that trust.*

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| <p>17 <i>And now, brethren, I wot that through ignorance ye did it, as did also your rulers.</i></p> | <p>"Now, brothers, I know that You acted in ignorance, as did Your leaders."</p> |
| <p>18 <i>But those things, which God before had shewed by the mouth of all his prophets, that Christ should suffer, he hath so fulfilled.</i></p> | <p>"But this is how God fulfilled what He had foretold through all the prophets — that His Christ would suffer."</p> |
| <p>19 <i>Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord;</i></p> | <p>"Repent therefore, and turn back, so that Your sins may be wiped out, that times of refreshing may come from the presence of the Lord,"</p> |
| <p>20 <i>And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you:</i></p> | <p>"and that He may send the Christ Who has been appointed for You — Jesus."</p> |
| <p>21 <i>Whom the heaven must receive until the times of restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all his holy prophets since the world began.</i></p> | <p>"Heaven must receive Him until the time comes for God to restore everything, as He promised long ago through His holy prophets."</p> |
| <p>22 <i>For Moses truly said unto the fathers, A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me; him shall ye hear in all things whatsoever he shall say unto you.</i></p> | <p>"For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own people. You must listen to everything He tells you.'"</p> |

- 23 *And it shall come to pass, that every soul, which will not hear that prophet, shall be destroyed from among the people.* "Anyone who does not listen to him will be completely cut off from among his people."
- 24 *Yea, and all the prophets from Samuel and those that follow after, as many as have spoken, have likewise foretold of these days.* "All the prophets from Samuel on, as many as have spoken, have foretold these days."
- 25 *Ye are the children of the prophets, and of the covenant which God made with our fathers, saying unto Abraham, And in thy seed shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed.* "You are the children of the prophets and of the covenant God made with your fathers. He said to Abraham, 'Through your offspring all peoples on earth will be blessed.'"

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. God's covenants are not mere contracts — they are sacred, unbreakable commitments backed by His own character.

- 26 *Unto you first God, having raised up his Son Jesus, sent him to bless you, in turning away every one of you from his iniquities.* "When God raised up His Son Jesus, He sent Him first to You to bless You by turning each of You from Your iniquities."

Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Isaac (EYE-zak) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Jacob (JAY-kub) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Pilate (PY-lat) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Samuel (SAM-yoo-el) — A prophet and the last of the judges — dedicated to God from birth; anointed both Saul and David as king; his name means 'heard of God' or 'asked of God.'

Solomon (SOL-oh-mon) — David's son and Israel's wisest and wealthiest king — built the first temple in Jerusalem; his name means 'peace' (shalom).

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 55:17; Acts 10:3; Acts 4:13; Luke 1:10; Luke 24:53
v6 — Acts 3:16; Acts 10:38; Acts 4:10; Acts 9:34; Mark 16:17
v7 — Mark 1:31; Mark 9:27; Acts 9:41; Mark 5:41; Luke 13:13
v12 — 2 Cor 3:5; John 3:27-28; Acts 14:11-15; Gen 41:16; Dan 2:28-30
v15 — Acts 2:24; Acts 2:32; Rev 21:6; John 1:4; Heb 2:10
v16 — Matt 21:21-22; Acts 14:9; Acts 3:6; Acts 4:10; Mark 16:17-18
v18 — Isa 53:1-12; Acts 26:22-23; Acts 2:23; Luke 24:26-27; Zech 12:10
v19 — Acts 2:38; Isa 44:22; Isa 43:25; Isa 1:16-20; Matt 13:15
v21 — Rom 8:21; Isa 1:26; Acts 1:11; Mark 9:11-13; Mal 4:5-6
v22 — Deut 18:15-19; Acts 7:37; Gal 4:4; John 1:17; Heb 5:9
v25 — Gen 22:18; Gal 3:8; Acts 2:39; 1 Chr 16:17; Rom 9:4-5
v26 — Matt 1:21; 1 John 3:5-8; Acts 3:22; Jude 1:24; Eph 5:26-27

Chapter 4

The priests and Sadducees arrested Peter and John for preaching the resurrection, but the number of believers grew to about five thousand. Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, declared before the council that salvation is found in no other name than Jesus Christ.

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| <p>1 <i>And as they spake unto the people, the priests, and the captain of the temple, and the Sadducees, came upon them,</i></p> | While Peter and John were speaking to the people, the priests, the captain of the temple guard, and the Sadducees came up to them. |
| <p>2 <i>Being grieved that they taught the people, and preached through Jesus the resurrection from the dead.</i></p> | They were greatly disturbed because the apostles were teaching the people and proclaiming in Jesus the resurrection from the dead. |
| <p>3 <i>And they laid hands on them, and put them in hold unto the next day: for it was now eventide.</i></p> | They seized Peter and John and put them in jail until the next day, for it was already evening. |
| <p>4 <i>Howbeit many of them which heard the word believed; and the number of the men was about five thousand.</i></p> | But many who heard the message believed, and the number of men grew to about five thousand. |
| <p>5 <i>And it came to pass on the morrow, that their rulers, and elders, and scribes,</i></p> | The next day the rulers, elders, and scribes met in Jerusalem. |

- 6 *And Annas the high priest, and Caiaphas, and John, and Alexander, and as many as were of the kindred of the high priest, were gathered together at Jerusalem.* Annas the high priest, Caiaphas, John, Alexander, and all the others of the high priest's family were there.
- 7 *And when they had set them in the midst, they asked, By what power, or by what name, have ye done this?* They had Peter and John brought before them and began to question them: "By what power or what name did you do this?"
- 8 *Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them, Ye rulers of the people, and elders of Israel,* Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said to them: "Rulers and elders of the people,
- 9 *If we this day be examined of the good deed done to the impotent man, by what means he is made whole;* if we are being called to account today for an act of kindness shown to a man who was lame, and asked how he was healed,
- 10 *Be it known unto you all, and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom ye crucified, whom God raised from the dead, even by him doth this man stand here before you whole.* then know this, You and all the people of Israel: It is by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom You crucified but whom God raised from the dead, that this man stands before you completely healed."
- 11 *This is the stone which was set at nought of you builders, which is become the head of the corner.* "Jesus is the stone You builders rejected, which has become the cornerstone."
- 12 *Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved.* "Salvation is found in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given to mankind by which we must be saved."
- 13 *Now when they saw the boldness of Peter and John, and perceived that they were unlearned and ignorant men, they marvelled; and they took knowledge of them, that they had been with Jesus.* When they saw the boldness of Peter and John, and realized that they were ordinary men with no formal education, they were astonished. They recognized that these men had been with Jesus.

- 14 *And beholding the man which was healed standing with them, they could say nothing against it.* But since they could see the man who had been healed standing there with them, there was nothing they could say.
- 15 *But when they had commanded them to go aside out of the council, they conferred among themselves,* They ordered them to leave the council and then talked the matter over among themselves.
- 16 *Saying, What shall we do to these men? for that indeed a notable miracle hath been done by them is manifest to all them that dwell in Jerusalem; and we cannot deny it.* "What are we going to do with these men?" they asked. "Everyone living in Jerusalem knows they have performed a notable miracle, and we cannot deny it."
- 17 *But that it spread no further among the people, let us straitly threaten them, that they speak henceforth to no man in this name.* "But to stop this from spreading further among the people, we must warn them to speak no longer to anyone in this name."
- 18 *And they called them, and commanded them not to speak at all nor teach in the name of Jesus.* They called them in again and commanded them not to speak or teach at all in the name of Jesus.
- 19 *But Peter and John answered and said unto them, Whether it be right in the sight of God to hearken unto you more than unto God, judge ye.* But Peter and John replied, "Which is right in God's eyes — to listen to you or to Him? You be the judges."
- 20 *For we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard.* "As for us, we cannot help speaking about what we have seen and heard."
- 21 *So when they had further threatened them, they let them go, finding nothing how they might punish them, because of the people: for all men glorified God for that which was done.* After further threats they let them go. They could not decide how to punish them, because all the people were praising God for what had happened.
- 22 *For the man was above forty years old, on whom this miracle of healing was shewed.* The man who was miraculously healed was over forty years old.

- 23 *And being let go, they went to their own company, and reported all that the chief priests and elders had said unto them.* On their release, Peter and John went back to their own people and reported what the chief priests and elders had said to them.
- 24 *And when they heard that, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord, and said, Lord, thou art God, which hast made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all that in them is:* When the people heard this, they raised their voices together in prayer to God. "Lord," they said, "You made the heavens and the earth and the sea, and everything in them."
- 25 *Who by the mouth of thy servant David hast said, Why did the heathen rage, and the people imagine vain things?* "You spoke through the mouth of your servant David: 'Why do the nations rage and the peoples plot in vain?'"
- 26 *The kings of the earth stood up, and the rulers were gathered together against the Lord, and against his Christ.* "'The kings of the earth rise up and the rulers band together against the Lord and against His anointed one.'"
- 27 *For of a truth against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, both Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles, and the people of Israel, were gathered together,* "Indeed Herod and Pontius Pilate met together with the Gentiles and the people of Israel in this city to conspire against Your holy Child Jesus, whom You anointed."
- 28 *For to do whatsoever thy hand and thy counsel determined before to be done.* "They did what Your power and will had decided beforehand should happen."
- 29 *And now, Lord, behold their threatenings: and grant unto thy servants, that with all boldness they may speak thy word,* "Now, Lord, see their threats and enable Your servants to speak Your word with great boldness."
- 30 *By stretching forth thine hand to heal; and that signs and wonders may be done by the name of thy holy child Jesus.* "Stretch out Your hand to heal and perform signs and wonders through the name of Your holy Child Jesus."

- 31 *And when they had prayed, the place was shaken where they were assembled together; and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and they spake the word of God with boldness.* After they prayed, the place where they were meeting was shaken. They were all filled with the Holy Ghost and spoke the word of God boldly.
- 32 *And the multitude of them that believed were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own; but they had all things common.* All the believers were one in heart and mind. No one claimed that any possession was his own, but they shared everything they had.
- 33 *And with great power gave the apostles witness of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus: and great grace was upon them all.* With great power the apostles continued to testify to the resurrection of the Lord Jesus, and great grace was on them all.
- 34 *Neither was there any among them that lacked: for as many as were possessors of lands or houses sold them, and brought the prices of the things that were sold,* There were no needy persons among them. Those who owned lands or houses sold them, brought the money from the sales,
- 35 *And laid them down at the apostles' feet: and distribution was made unto every man according as he had need.* and placed it at the apostles' feet. It was distributed to anyone who had need.
- 36 *And Joses, who by the apostles was surnamed Barnabas, (which is, being interpreted, The son of consolation,) a Levite, and of the country of Cyprus,* Joseph, a Levite from Cyprus, whom the apostles called Barnabas — meaning "son of encouragement" —

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Barnabas** (BAR-nuh-bus) — "son of encouragement" — A Levite from Cyprus who became a key leader and traveling companion of the apostle Paul. He introduced Paul to the Jerusalem church and later worked with him on the first missionary journey.

- 37 *Having land, sold it, and brought the money, and laid it at the apostles' feet.* sold a field he owned, brought the money, and placed it at the apostles' feet.

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Sadducees (*SAD-yoo-seez*) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Caiaphas (*KY-ah-fas*) — The Jewish high priest during Jesus's trial — he declared it better for one man to die for the nation; he unwittingly prophesied Christ's death for all people.

Herod (*HEHR-od*) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 22:4; Acts 23:6-9; Acts 6:12; Acts 5:24; Acts 5:26
- v11 — Ps 118:22-23; Isa 28:16; Mark 12:10-12; Matt 21:42-45; 1 Pet 2:6-8
- v12 — John 14:6; 1 Cor 3:11; John 3:36; 1 Tim 2:5-6; 1 John 5:11-12
- v13 — 1 Cor 1:27; John 7:15; Matt 11:25; Acts 2:7-12; Matt 26:73
- v19 — Acts 5:29; Ex 1:17; 1 Cor 10:15; 1 Tim 2:3; 1 Kgs 22:14
- v20 — Acts 22:15; Jer 20:9; 1 Cor 9:16-17; 1 John 1:1-3; Acts 5:32
- v24 — Ex 20:11; Jer 32:17; Neh 9:6; Jer 10:10-12; 2 Kgs 19:15
- v26 — Ps 2:2; Rev 17:12-14; Dan 9:24; Ps 83:2-8; Acts 10:38
- v29 — Acts 4:13; Phil 1:14; Acts 14:3; Acts 4:31; 2 Tim 4:17
- v31 — Matt 21:22; Isa 65:24; Acts 2:4; Acts 2:2; Acts 16:25-26
- v32 — 1 Cor 1:10; Eph 4:2-6; 1 Pet 3:8; John 17:21-23; Phil 2:1-2
- v33 — John 1:16; Acts 1:22; Acts 1:8; Acts 4:30; 1 Thess 1:5

Chapter 5

Ananias and Sapphira lied to the Holy Ghost about the price of their land and both fell dead, bringing great fear on the whole church. The apostles performed many signs and wonders, were arrested again by the high priest, and were beaten but rejoiced that they were counted worthy to suffer for the name of Christ.

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| <p>1 But a certain man named Ananias,
with Sapphira his wife, sold a
possession,</p> | <p>Now a man named Ananias, together
with his wife Sapphira, sold a piece of
property.</p> |
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- 2 *And kept back part of the price, his wife also being privy to it, and brought a certain part, and laid it at the apostles' feet.* With his wife's full knowledge He kept back part of the money for Himself and brought only a portion and placed it at the apostles' feet.
- 3 *But Peter said, Ananias, why hath Satan filled thine heart to lie to the Holy Ghost, and to keep back part of the price of the land?* Then Peter said, "Ananias, how is it that Satan has so filled your heart that you have lied to the Holy Ghost and kept for Yourself some of the money You received for the land?"
- 4 *Whiles it remained, was it not thine own? and after it was sold, was it not in thine own power? why hast thou conceived this thing in thine heart? thou hast not lied unto men, but unto God.* "Didn't the property belong to You before it was sold? And after it was sold, wasn't the money at Your disposal? What made You think of doing such a thing? You have not lied to men but to God."
- 5 *And Ananias hearing these words fell down, and gave up the ghost: and great fear came on all them that heard these things.* When Ananias heard this, He fell down and died. Great fear seized all who heard what had happened.
- 6 *And the young men arose, wound him up, and carried him out, and buried him.* Some young men came forward, wrapped up His body, carried Him out, and buried Him.
- 7 *And it was about the space of three hours after, when his wife, not knowing what was done, came in.* About three hours later his wife came in, not knowing what had happened.
- 8 *And Peter answered unto her, Tell me whether ye sold the land for so much? And she said, Yea, for so much.* Peter asked her, "Tell me, is this the price you and Ananias got for the land?" "Yes," she said, "that is the price."
- 9 *Then Peter said unto her, How is it that ye have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord? behold, the feet of them which have buried thy husband are at the door, and shall carry thee out.* Peter said to her, "How could you agree to test the Spirit of the Lord? Listen! The feet of the men who buried Your husband are at the door, and they will carry You out also."

- 10 *Then fell she down straightway at his feet, and yielded up the ghost: and the young men came in, and found her dead, and, carrying her forth, buried her by her husband.* At that moment she fell down at His feet and died. The young men came in, found her dead, and carried her out and buried her beside her husband.
- 11 *And great fear came upon all the church, and upon as many as heard these things.* Great fear seized the whole church and all who heard about these events.
- 12 *And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people; (and they were all with one accord in Solomon's porch.* The apostles performed many signs and wonders among the people. All the believers used to meet together in Solomon's Porch.
- 13 *And of the rest durst no man join himself to them: but the people magnified them.* No one else dared join them, even though they were highly regarded by the people.
- 14 *And believers were the more added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women.)* Nevertheless, more and more men and women believed in the Lord and were added to their number.
- 15 *Insomuch that they brought forth the sick into the streets, and laid them on beds and couches, that at the least the shadow of Peter passing by might overshadow some of them.* As a result, people brought the sick into the streets and placed them on beds and mats so that at least Peter's shadow might fall on some of them as he passed by.
- 16 *There came also a multitude out of the cities round about unto Jerusalem, bringing sick folks, and them which were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed every one.* Crowds also gathered from the towns around Jerusalem, bringing their sick and those troubled by unclean spirits, and all of them were healed.
- 17 *Then the high priest rose up, and all they that were with him, (which is the sect of the Sadducees,) and were filled with indignation,* Then the high priest and all his associates — who were members of the sect of the Sadducees — were filled with jealousy.
- 18 *And laid their hands on the apostles, and put them in the common prison.* They arrested the apostles and put them in the public jail.

- 19 *But the angel of the Lord by night opened the prison doors, and brought them forth, and said,* But during the night an angel of the Lord opened the prison doors and brought them out, saying,
- 20 *Go, stand and speak in the temple to the people all the words of this life.* "Go, stand in the temple courts and tell the people all about this new life."
- 21 *And when they heard that, they entered into the temple early in the morning, and taught. But the high priest came, and they that were with him, and called the council together, and all the senate of the children of Israel, and sent to the prison to have them brought.* At daybreak they entered the temple courts and began to teach. When the high priest and his associates arrived, they called together the Sanhedrin — the full assembly of the elders of Israel — and sent to the jail for the apostles.
- 22 *But when the officers came, and found them not in the prison, they returned, and told,* But when the officers arrived at the jail, they did not find them there. They went back and reported,
- 23 *Saying, The prison truly found we shut with all safety, and the keepers standing without before the doors: but when we had opened, we found no man within.* "We found the jail securely locked with the guards standing at the doors, but when we opened them, we found no one inside."
- 24 *Now when the high priest and the captain of the temple and the chief priests heard these things, they doubted of them whereunto this would grow.* When the captain of the temple guard and the chief priests heard this, they were baffled and wondered what this could lead to.
- 25 *Then came one and told them, saying, Behold, the men whom ye put in prison are standing in the temple, and teaching the people.* Then someone came and reported, "The men you put in jail are standing in the temple courts and teaching the people."
- 26 *Then went the captain with the officers, and brought them without violence: for they feared the people, lest they should have been stoned.* At that, the captain went with his officers and brought the apostles. They did not use force, because they feared that the people would stone them.

- 27 *And when they had brought them, they set them before the council: and the high priest asked them,* Having brought the apostles, they placed them before the Sanhedrin to be questioned by the high priest.
- 28 *Saying, Did not we straitly command you that ye should not teach in this name? and, behold, ye have filled Jerusalem with your doctrine, and intend to bring this man's blood upon us.* "We gave you strict orders not to teach in this name," he said. "Yet you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching and are determined to make us guilty of this man's blood."
- 29 *Then Peter and the other apostles answered and said, We ought to obey God rather than men.* Peter and the other apostles replied, "We must obey God rather than men."
- 30 *The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom ye slew and hanged on a tree.* "The God of our fathers raised Jesus from the dead — whom You killed by hanging Him on a tree."
- 31 *Him hath God exalted with his right hand to be a Prince and a Saviour, for to give repentance to Israel, and forgiveness of sins.* "God exalted Him to His own right hand as Prince and Savior to give repentance and forgiveness of sins to Israel."
- 32 *And we are his witnesses of these things; and so is also the Holy Ghost, whom God hath given to them that obey him.* "We are witnesses of these things, and so is the Holy Ghost, whom God has given to those who obey Him."
- 33 *When they heard that, they were cut to the heart, and took counsel to slay them.* When they heard this, they were furious and wanted to put them to death.
- 34 *Then stood there up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law, had in reputation among all the people, and commanded to put the apostles forth a little space;* But a Pharisee named Gamaliel, a teacher of the law who was honored by all the people, stood up in the Sanhedrin and ordered that the men be put outside for a little while.

- 35 *And said unto them, Ye men of Israel, take heed to yourselves what ye intend to do as touching these men.* Then He addressed the council: "Men of Israel, consider carefully what You intend to do to these men."
- 36 *For before these days rose up Theudas, boasting himself to be somebody; to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves: who was slain; and all, as many as obeyed him, were scattered, and brought to nought.* "Some time ago Theudas appeared, claiming to be somebody, and about four hundred men rallied to Him. He was killed, all His followers were scattered, and it all came to nothing."
- 37 *After this man rose up Judas of Galilee in the days of the taxing, and drew away much people after him: he also perished; and all, even as many as obeyed him, were dispersed.* "After him, Judas the Galilean appeared in the days of the census and led a band of people in revolt. He too was killed, and all his followers were scattered."
- 38 *And now I say unto you, Refrain from these men, and let them alone: for if this counsel or this work be of men, it will come to nought:* "Therefore, in the present case I advise you: Leave these men alone. Let them go. If their purpose or activity is of human origin, it will fail."
- 39 *But if it be of God, ye cannot overthrow it; lest haply ye be found even to fight against God.* "But if it is from God, You will not be able to stop these men. You will only find yourselves fighting against God."
- 40 *And to him they agreed: and when they had called the apostles, and beaten them, they commanded that they should not speak in the name of Jesus, and let them go.* His speech persuaded them. They called the apostles in, had them flogged, commanded them not to speak in the name of Jesus, and let them go.
- 41 *And they departed from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were counted worthy to suffer shame for his name.* The apostles left the Sanhedrin rejoicing because they had been counted worthy to suffer disgrace for the Name.
- 42 *And daily in the temple, and in every house, they ceased not to teach and preach Jesus Christ.* Day after day, in the temple courts and from house to house, they never stopped teaching and proclaiming the good news that Jesus is the Christ.

Words in this chapter:

Sanhedrin (*san-HEE-drin*) — The supreme Jewish council of 71 members — the highest religious and legal authority in Judea; it tried Jesus and later persecuted the apostles.

Ananias (*an-ah-NY-as*) — Several NT figures share this name — notably the disciple who laid hands on Saul of Tarsus after his conversion, restoring his sight; also the man who lied to the Holy Spirit in Acts 5.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Jer 23:24; Isa 29:15; John 13:27; 1 Pet 5:8; Acts 5:9
- v11 — Acts 5:5; 1 Cor 10:11-12; Acts 19:17; Heb 4:1; Phil 2:12
- v12 — Acts 19:11; Heb 2:4; 2 Cor 12:12; Acts 14:3; Rom 15:19
- v15 — Acts 19:11-12; Matt 14:36; John 14:12; Matt 9:21
- v19 — Acts 16:26; Ps 34:7; Acts 12:7-11; Ps 105:17-20; Acts 8:26
- v20 — John 6:63; John 6:68; 1 John 5:11-12; Matt 21:23; 1 John 1:1-3
- v29 — Acts 4:19; 1 Sam 15:24; Mark 7:7-9; Gen 3:17; Rev 14:8-12
- v30 — Gal 3:13; 1 Pet 2:24; Acts 10:39; Acts 13:28-29
- v31 — Luke 24:47; Acts 2:33; Heb 2:10; Acts 11:18; Luke 2:11
- v39 — Prov 21:30; Isa 46:10; Matt 16:18; 1 Cor 1:25; Acts 7:51
- v41 — Jas 1:2; 1 Pet 4:13-16; Luke 6:22; Phil 1:29; John 15:21
- v42 — Acts 2:46; Acts 20:20; Luke 21:37; Acts 9:20; Acts 8:35

Chapter 6

The apostles appointed seven men, including Stephen, to serve the daily distribution so that they could devote themselves to prayer and the word. Stephen, full of faith and power, performed great wonders, and his opponents in the synagogue brought false witnesses against him before the council.

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| <p>1 <i>And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.</i></p> | <p>In those days when the number of disciples was growing, the Hellenistic Jews complained against the Hebraic Jews because their widows were being overlooked in the daily distribution of food.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then the twelve called the multitude of the disciples unto them, and said, It is not reason that we should leave the word of God, and serve tables.</i></p> | <p>So the twelve gathered all the disciples together and said, "It would not be right for us to neglect the ministry of the word of God in order to wait on tables."</p> |

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| 3 <i>Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business.</i> | "Brothers, choose seven men from among You who are known to be full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom. We will turn this responsibility over to them." |
| 4 <i>But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word.</i> | "We will give our attention to prayer and the ministry of the word." |
| 5 <i>And the saying pleased the whole multitude: and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip, and Prochorus, and Nicanor, and Timon, and Parmenas, and Nicolas a proselyte of Antioch:</i> | This proposal pleased the whole group. They chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost; also Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolas from Antioch, a convert to Judaism. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Stephen** (STEE-vun) — "crown" — *One of the first seven deacons of the Jerusalem church. A man of great faith and power, he became the first Christian martyr, stoned to death for his bold testimony of Christ (Acts 7).*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Philip** (FIL-ip) — "lover of horses" — *One of the seven deacons. He later became known as Philip the Evangelist, preaching in Samaria and leading the Ethiopian eunuch to faith in Christ (Acts 8).*

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| 6 <i>Whom they set before the apostles: and when they had prayed, they laid their hands on them.</i> | They presented these men to the apostles, who prayed and laid their hands on them. |
| 7 <i>And the word of God increased; and the number of the disciples multiplied in Jerusalem greatly; and a great company of the priests were obedient to the faith.</i> | So the word of God spread. The number of disciples in Jerusalem grew rapidly, and a large number of priests became obedient to the faith. |
| 8 <i>And Stephen, full of faith and power, did great wonders and miracles among the people.</i> | Now Stephen, full of faith and power, performed great wonders and signs among the people. |

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| <p>9 <i>Then there arose certain of the synagogue, which is called the synagogue of the Libertines, and Cyrenians, and Alexandrians, and of them of Cilicia and of Asia, disputing with Stephen.</i></p> <p>10 <i>And they were not able to resist the wisdom and the spirit by which he spake.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Then they suborned men, which said, We have heard him speak blasphemous words against Moses, and against God.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And they stirred up the people, and the elders, and the scribes, and came upon him, and caught him, and brought him to the council,</i></p> <p>13 <i>And set up false witnesses, which said, This man ceaseth not to speak blasphemous words against this holy place, and the law:</i></p> <p>14 <i>For we have heard him say, that this Jesus of Nazareth shall destroy this place, and shall change the customs which Moses delivered us.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And all that sat in the council, looking stedfastly on him, saw his face as it had been the face of an angel.</i></p> | <p>Opposition arose from members of the Synagogue of the Freedmen — as it was called — along with Jews from Cyrene and Alexandria, and from the provinces of Cilicia and Asia. These men began to argue with Stephen.</p> <p>But they could not stand up against the wisdom the Spirit gave Him as He spoke.</p> <p>Then they secretly persuaded some men to say, "We have heard Stephen speak blasphemous words against Moses and against God."</p> <p>This stirred up the people and the elders and the scribes. They seized Stephen and brought him before the Sanhedrin.</p> <p>They produced false witnesses, who testified, "This fellow never stops speaking against this holy place and against the law."</p> <p>"For we have heard Him say that this Jesus of Nazareth will destroy this place and change the customs Moses handed down to us."</p> <p>All who were sitting in the Sanhedrin looked intently at Stephen, and they saw that his face was like the face of an angel.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Sanhedrin (*san-HEE-drin*) — The supreme Jewish council of 71 members — the highest religious and legal authority in Judea; it tried Jesus and later persecuted the apostles.

scribes — Professional experts in the Law of Moses — they copied Scripture and interpreted it; often allied with the Pharisees in opposing Jesus.

Nazareth (NAZ-ah-reth) — The town in Galilee where Jesus grew up — hometown of Mary and Joseph; the Nazarenes rejected Jesus when He declared His mission in their synagogue.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 2:41; Acts 4:35; Acts 6:7; Jas 5:9; Acts 9:39
- v2 — Deut 1:9-14; Ex 18:17-26; 2 Tim 2:4; Neh 6:3
- v3 — 1 Tim 3:7-15; Jas 3:17-18; Deut 1:13; Num 27:18-19; 1 Tim 5:10
- v4 — Acts 1:14; 1 Tim 4:13-16; Phil 1:9-11; Acts 2:42
- v5 — Acts 11:24; Acts 21:8; Acts 8:5-40
- v6 — Num 8:10; 2 Tim 1:6; Acts 1:24; Acts 8:17; 1 Tim 4:14
- v7 — Acts 19:20; Acts 12:24; Col 1:6; Heb 5:9
- v8 — Acts 4:29-30; Acts 7:55; Acts 6:5; Acts 6:10; 1 Tim 3:13
- v10 — Luke 21:15; Matt 10:19-20; 1 Cor 2:4; John 7:46; Luke 12:11-12
- v12 — Prov 15:18; Acts 14:2
- v14 — Dan 9:26; Heb 12:26-28; Acts 21:21; Acts 15:1
- v15 — Matt 13:43; Eccl 8:1; Ex 34:29-35; Matt 17:2

Chapter 7

Stephen delivered a sweeping defense before the council, tracing Israel's history from Abraham through Moses to Solomon. He accused them of resisting the Holy Ghost as their fathers had done, and they stoned him to death as he saw heaven opened and the Son of man standing at the right hand of God.

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| 1 | <i>Then said the high priest, Are these things so?</i> | Then the high priest asked Stephen, "Are these charges true?" |
| 2 | <i>And he said, Men, brethren, and fathers, hearken; The God of glory appeared unto our father Abraham, when he was in Mesopotamia, before he dwelt in Charran,</i> | Stephen replied: "Brothers and fathers, listen to me! The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham while he was still in Mesopotamia, before he lived in Haran." |
| 3 | <i>And said unto him, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and come into the land which I shall shew thee.</i> | "He said to him, 'Leave your country and your people and go to the land I will show you.'" |

- 4 *Then came he out of the land of the Chaldaeans, and dwelt in Charran: and from thence, after his father was dead, he removed him into this land, wherein ye now dwell.* "So he left the land of the Chaldeans and lived in Haran. After his father died, God sent him to this land where you are now living."
- 5 *And he gave him none inheritance in it, no, not so much as to set his foot on: yet he promised that he would give it to him for a possession, and to his seed after him, when as yet he had no child.* "God gave him no inheritance here, not even a foot of ground. But God promised Him that He and His descendants after Him would possess the land, even though at that time Abraham had no child."
- 6 *And God spake on this wise, That his seed should sojourn in a strange land; and that they should bring them into bondage, and entreat them evil four hundred years.* "God spoke to Him this way: 'Your descendants will be strangers in a foreign land, and they will be enslaved and mistreated for four hundred years.'"
- 7 *And the nation to whom they shall be in bondage will I judge, said God: and after that shall they come forth, and serve me in this place.* "'But I will punish the nation they serve as slaves,' God said, 'and afterward they will come out and worship me in this place.'"
- 8 *And he gave him the covenant of circumcision: and so Abraham begat Isaac, and circumcised him the eighth day; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat the twelve patriarchs.* "Then He gave Abraham the covenant of circumcision. Abraham became the father of Isaac and circumcised him on the eighth day. Isaac became the father of Jacob, and Jacob became the father of the twelve patriarchs."
- 9 *And the patriarchs, moved with envy, sold Joseph into Egypt: but God was with him,* "Because the patriarchs were jealous of Joseph, they sold him as a slave into Egypt. But God was with Him
- 10 *And delivered him out of all his afflictions, and gave him favour and wisdom in the sight of Pharaoh king of Egypt; and he made him governor over Egypt and all his house.* and rescued him from all his troubles. He gave Joseph wisdom and enabled him to gain the favor of Pharaoh king of Egypt. So Pharaoh made him ruler over Egypt and all his household."

- 11 *Now there came a dearth over all the land of Egypt and Chanaan, and great affliction: and our fathers found no sustenance.* "Then a famine struck all Egypt and Canaan, bringing great suffering, and our ancestors could not find food."
- 12 *But when Jacob heard that there was corn in Egypt, he sent out our fathers first.* "When Jacob heard that there was grain in Egypt, he sent our forefathers there on their first visit."
- 13 *And at the second time Joseph was made known to his brethren; and Joseph's kindred was made known unto Pharaoh.* "On their second visit, Joseph told his brothers who he was, and Pharaoh learned about Joseph's family."
- 14 *And Joseph sent, and called his father Jacob to him, and all his kindred, threescore and fifteen souls.* "After this, Joseph sent for his father Jacob and his whole family, seventy-five in all."
- 15 *So Jacob went down into Egypt, and died, he, and our fathers,* "Then Jacob went down to Egypt, where he and our ancestors died."
- 16 *And were carried over into Sychem, and laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought for a sum of money of the sons of Emmor the father of Sychem.* "Their bodies were brought back to Shechem and placed in the tomb that Abraham had bought from the sons of Hamor in Shechem for a certain sum of money."
- 17 *But when the time of the promise drew nigh, which God had sworn to Abraham, the people grew and multiplied in Egypt,* "As the time drew near for God to fulfill His promise to Abraham, the number of our people in Egypt greatly increased."
- 18 *Till another king arose, which knew not Joseph.* "Then a different king, who knew nothing about Joseph, became ruler of Egypt."
- 19 *The same dealt subtilly with our kindred, and evil entreated our fathers, so that they cast out their young children, to the end they might not live.* "He dealt treacherously with our people and oppressed our ancestors by forcing them to throw out their newborn babies so that they would die."

- 20 *In which time Moses was born, and was exceeding fair, and nourished up in his father's house three months:* "At that time Moses was born, and he was no ordinary child. For three months he was raised in his father's house."
- 21 *And when he was cast out, Pharaoh's daughter took him up, and nourished him for her own son.* "When he was placed outside, Pharaoh's daughter took him and raised him as her own son."
- 22 *And Moses was learned in all the wisdom of the Egyptians, and was mighty in words and in deeds.* "Moses was educated in all the wisdom of the Egyptians and was powerful in speech and action."
- 23 *And when he was full forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brethren the children of Israel.* "When Moses was forty years old, he decided to visit his own people, the Israelites."
- 24 *And seeing one of them suffer wrong, he defended him, and avenged him that was oppressed, and smote the Egyptian:* "He saw one of them being mistreated by an Egyptian, so he went to his defense and avenged him by striking down the Egyptian."
- 25 *For he supposed his brethren would have understood how that God by his hand would deliver them: but they understood not.* "Moses thought that his own people would realize that God was using Him to rescue them, but they did not."
- 26 *And the next day he shewed himself unto them as they strove, and would have set them at one again, saying, Sirs, ye are brethren; why do ye wrong one to another?* "The next day Moses came upon two Israelites who were fighting. He tried to make peace between them and said, 'Men, you are brothers; why are you hurting each other?'"
- 27 *But he that did his neighbour wrong thrust him away, saying, Who made thee a ruler and a judge over us?* "But the man who was mistreating the other pushed Moses aside and said, 'Who made you ruler and judge over us?'"
- 28 *Wilt thou kill me, as thou didst the Egyptian yesterday?* "'Are you thinking of killing me as you killed the Egyptian yesterday?'"

- 29 *Then fled Moses at this saying, and was a stranger in the land of Madian, where he begat two sons.* "When Moses heard this, he fled to Midian, where he lived as an outsider and had two sons."
- 30 *And when forty years were expired, there appeared to him in the wilderness of mount Sina an angel of the Lord in a flame of fire in a bush.* "After forty years had passed, an angel appeared to Moses in the flames of a burning bush in the wilderness near Mount Sinai."
- 31 *When Moses saw it, he wondered at the sight: and as he drew near to behold it, the voice of the Lord came unto him,* "When Moses saw it, he was amazed at the sight. As he went over to look more closely, he heard the Lord say:"
- 32 *Saying, I am the God of thy fathers, the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. Then Moses trembled, and durst not behold.* "'I am the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.' Moses trembled with fear and did not dare to look."
- 33 *Then said the Lord to him, Put off thy shoes from thy feet: for the place where thou standest is holy ground.* "Then the Lord said to Him, 'Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground.'"
- 34 *I have seen, I have seen the affliction of my people which is in Egypt, and I have heard their groaning, and am come down to deliver them. And now come, I will send thee into Egypt.* "'I have indeed seen the oppression of my people in Egypt. I have heard their groaning and have come down to set them free. Now come, I will send you back to Egypt.'"
- 35 *This Moses whom they refused, saying, Who made thee a ruler and a judge? the same did God send to be a ruler and a deliverer by the hand of the angel which appeared to him in the bush.* "This is the same Moses they had rejected with the words, 'Who made you ruler and judge?' He is the one God sent to be their ruler and deliverer through the angel that appeared to him in the bush."
- 36 *He brought them out, after that he had shewed wonders and signs in the land of Egypt, and in the Red sea, and in the wilderness forty years.* "He led them out and performed wonders and signs in Egypt, at the Red Sea, and for forty years in the wilderness."

- 37 *This is that Moses, which said unto the children of Israel, A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me; him shall ye hear.* "This is the Moses who told the Israelites, 'God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own people.'"
- 38 *This is he, that was in the church in the wilderness with the angel which spake to him in the mount Sina, and with our fathers: who received the lively oracles to give unto us:* "He was in the assembly in the wilderness, with the angel who spoke to him on Mount Sinai, and with our ancestors. He received living words to pass on to us."
- 39 *To whom our fathers would not obey, but thrust him from them, and in their hearts turned back again into Egypt,* "But our ancestors refused to obey him. They rejected him and in their hearts turned back to Egypt."
- 40 *Saying unto Aaron, Make us gods to go before us: for as for this Moses, which brought us out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.* "They told Aaron, 'Make us gods who will go before us. As for this fellow Moses who led us out of Egypt — we don't know what has happened to him.'"
- 41 *And they made a calf in those days, and offered sacrifice unto the idol, and rejoiced in the works of their own hands.* "That was the time they made an idol in the form of a calf. They brought sacrifices to it and celebrated what their own hands had made."
- 42 *Then God turned, and gave them up to worship the host of heaven; as it is written in the book of the prophets, O ye house of Israel, have ye offered to me slain beasts and sacrifices by the space of forty years in the wilderness?* "But God turned away from them and gave them over to the worship of the heavenly bodies. This agrees with what is written in the book of the prophets: 'Did you bring me sacrifices and offerings for forty years in the wilderness, house of Israel?'"
- 43 *Yea, ye took up the tabernacle of Moloch, and the star of your god Remphan, figures which ye made to worship them: and I will carry you away beyond Babylon.* "'You have taken up the tabernacle of Molek and the star of your god Rephan, the idols you made to worship. Therefore I will send you into exile beyond Babylon.'"

- 44 *Our fathers had the tabernacle of witness in the wilderness, as he had appointed, speaking unto Moses, that he should make it according to the fashion that he had seen.* "Our ancestors had the tabernacle of witness with them in the wilderness. It had been made as God directed Moses, according to the pattern he had seen."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Tabernacle** (TAB-ur-nak-ul) — the tent of meeting; Israel's portable worship structure where God's presence dwelt among His people. God gave Moses the exact design for this tent on Mount Sinai, and it served as the center of Israelite worship until Solomon built the permanent temple.

- 45 *Which also our fathers that came after brought in with Jesus into the possession of the Gentiles, whom God drave out before the face of our fathers, unto the days of David;* "Our ancestors who came after received the tabernacle and brought it with them when they took the land from the nations God drove out before them. It remained in the land until the time of David."
- 46 *Who found favour before God, and desired to find a tabernacle for the God of Jacob.* "David enjoyed God's favor and asked that He might provide a dwelling place for the God of Jacob."
- 47 *But Solomon built him an house.* "But it was Solomon who built a house for him."
- 48 *Howbeit the most High dwelleth not in temples made with hands; as saith the prophet,* "However, the Most High does not live in houses made by human hands. As the prophet says:"
- 49 *Heaven is my throne, and earth is my footstool: what house will ye build me? saith the Lord: or what is the place of my rest?* "'Heaven is my throne and the earth is my footstool. What kind of house will You build for me? says the Lord. Or where will my resting place be?'"
- 50 *Hath not my hand made all these things?* "'Has not my hand made all these things?'"
- 51 *Ye stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, ye do always resist the Holy Ghost: as your fathers did, so do ye.* "You stubborn people! You are uncircumcised in heart and ears. You are just like Your ancestors — you always resist the Holy Ghost."

- 52 *Which of the prophets have not your fathers persecuted? and they have slain them which shewed before of the coming of the Just One; of whom ye have been now the betrayers and murderers:* "Was there ever a prophet Your ancestors did not persecute? They even killed those who predicted the coming of the Righteous One. And now you have betrayed and murdered Him."
- 53 *Who have received the law by the disposition of angels, and have not kept it.* "You who have received the law that was given through angels but have not obeyed it."
- 54 *When they heard these things, they were cut to the heart, and they gnashed on him with their teeth.* When the members of the Sanhedrin heard this, they were furious and ground their teeth at Him.
- 55 *But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God,* But Stephen, full of the Holy Ghost, looked up to heaven and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing at the right hand of God.
- 56 *And said, Behold, I see the heavens opened, and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God.* "Look," he said, "I see heaven open and the Son of man standing at the right hand of God."
- 57 *Then they cried out with a loud voice, and stopped their ears, and ran upon him with one accord,* At this they covered their ears and, yelling at the top of their voices, they all rushed at Him.
- 58 *And cast him out of the city, and stoned him: and the witnesses laid down their clothes at a young man's feet, whose name was Saul.* They dragged him out of the city and began to stone him. Meanwhile, the witnesses laid their clothes at the feet of a young man named Saul.
- 59 *And they stoned Stephen, calling upon God, and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit.* While they were stoning Him, Stephen prayed, "Lord Jesus, receive my spirit."
- 60 *And he kneeled down, and cried with a loud voice, Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep.* Then He fell on His knees and cried out, "Lord, do not hold this sin against them." When He had said this, He fell asleep.

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Canaan (*KAY-nan*) — The Promised Land — the territory from the Jordan River to the Mediterranean, promised to Abraham and his descendants; later renamed Israel.

Haran (*HEHR-an*) — The city in upper Mesopotamia where Abraham's family stopped on the way from Ur — where Terah died and where Jacob later fled to Laban.

Sinai (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

- v9** — Gen 39:2; Ps 105:17; Isa 43:2; Isa 41:10; Gen 45:4
- v10** — 2 Tim 4:18; Prov 3:4; Prov 2:6; Gen 48:16; Ps 22:24
- v34** — Ex 3:7-10; Neh 9:9; Ex 4:31; Ps 106:44; Ex 3:14
- v37** — Deut 18:15-19; Acts 3:22-23; John 18:37; Matt 17:3-5; Acts 7:38
- v38** — Rom 3:2; Heb 5:12; 1 Pet 4:11; Acts 7:53; John 1:17
- v42** — Amos 5:25-26; Ezek 20:39; Jer 19:13; Ps 81:11-12; Isa 63:10
- v48** — Acts 17:24-25; Isa 66:1-2; 1 Kgs 8:27; 2 Chr 2:5-6; 2 Chr 6:18
- v49** — Isa 66:1; Ps 11:4; John 4:21; Jer 23:24; Rev 3:21
- v51** — Deut 10:16; Isa 63:10; Jer 4:4; Eph 4:30; Lev 26:41
- v52** — Matt 5:12; 2 Chr 36:16; 1 Kgs 19:10; 1 Thess 2:15; Jer 2:30
- v53** — Heb 2:2; Gal 3:19; Acts 7:38; John 7:19; Deut 33:2
- v60** — Matt 5:44; Luke 23:34; 1 Cor 15:20; Rom 12:14-21; 1 Thess 4:13-14

Chapter 8

A great persecution scattered the church from Jerusalem, and Philip went down to Samaria where many believed and were baptized. Philip then met the Ethiopian eunuch on the road to Gaza, preached Jesus to him from Isaiah, and baptized him after the eunuch confessed his faith in Christ.

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| 1 <i>And Saul was consenting unto his death. And at that time there was a great persecution against the church which was at Jerusalem; and they were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judaea and Samaria, except the apostles.</i> | Saul approved of Stephen's death. On that day a great persecution broke out against the church in Jerusalem, and all except the apostles were scattered throughout Judaea and Samaria. |
| 2 <i>And devout men carried Stephen to his burial, and made great lamentation over him.</i> | Godly men buried Stephen and mourned deeply for him. |
| 3 <i>As for Saul, he made havock of the church, entering into every house, and haling men and women committed them to prison.</i> | But Saul began to destroy the church. Going from house to house, he dragged off both men and women and put them in prison. |
| 4 <i>Therefore they that were scattered abroad went every where preaching the word.</i> | Those who had been scattered preached the word wherever they went. |
| 5 <i>Then Philip went down to the city of Samaria, and preached Christ unto them.</i> | Philip went down to a city in Samaria and proclaimed Christ there. |
| 6 <i>And the people with one accord gave heed unto those things which Philip spake, hearing and seeing the miracles which he did.</i> | When the crowds heard Philip and saw the signs he performed, they all paid close attention to what he said. |
| 7 <i>For unclean spirits, crying with loud voice, came out of many that were possessed with them: and many taken with palsies, and that were lame, were healed.</i> | With shrieks, unclean spirits came out of many, and many who were paralyzed or lame were healed. |
| 8 <i>And there was great joy in that city.</i> | So there was great joy in that city. |

- 9 *But there was a certain man, called Simon, which beforetime in the same city used sorcery, and bewitched the people of Samaria, giving out that himself was some great one:* Now for some time a man named Simon had practiced sorcery in the city and amazed all the people of Samaria. He claimed to be someone great,
- 10 *To whom they all gave heed, from the least to the greatest, saying, This man is the great power of God.* and all the people, both high and low, gave him their attention and said, "This man is rightly called the Great Power of God."
- 11 *And to him they had regard, because that of long time he had bewitched them with sorceries.* They followed him because he had amazed them for a long time with his sorcery.
- 12 *But when they believed Philip preaching the things concerning the kingdom of God, and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.* But when they believed Philip as he proclaimed the good news of the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.
- 13 *Then Simon himself believed also: and when he was baptized, he continued with Philip, and wondered, beholding the miracles and signs which were done.* Simon himself believed and was baptized. He followed Philip everywhere, astonished by the great signs and miracles he saw.
- 14 *Now when the apostles which were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent unto them Peter and John:* When the apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had accepted the word of God, they sent Peter and John to Samaria.
- 15 *Who, when they were come down, prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Ghost:* When they arrived, they prayed for the new believers there that they might receive the Holy Ghost,
- 16 *(For as yet he was fallen upon none of them: only they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.)* because the Holy Ghost had not yet come on any of them; they had simply been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.

- 17 *Then laid they their hands on them, and they received the Holy Ghost.* Then Peter and John placed their hands on them, and they received the Holy Ghost.
- 18 *And when Simon saw that through laying on of the apostles' hands the Holy Ghost was given, he offered them money,* When Simon saw that the Holy Ghost was given at the laying on of the apostles' hands, He offered them money
- 19 *Saying, Give me also this power, that on whomsoever I lay hands, he may receive the Holy Ghost.* and said, "Give me also this ability so that everyone on whom I lay my hands may receive the Holy Ghost."
- 20 *But Peter said unto him, Thy money perish with thee, because thou hast thought that the gift of God may be purchased with money.* Peter answered: "May your money go to destruction with you, because you thought you could buy the gift of God with money."
- 21 *Thou hast neither part nor lot in this matter: for thy heart is not right in the sight of God.* "You have no part or share in this ministry, because your heart is not right before God."
- 22 *Repent therefore of this thy wickedness, and pray God, if perhaps the thought of thine heart may be forgiven thee.* "Repent of this wickedness and pray to the Lord in the hope that He may forgive you for having such a thought in your heart."
- 23 *For I perceive that thou art in the gall of bitterness, and in the bond of iniquity.* "For I see that you are full of bitterness and captive to sin."
- 24 *Then answered Simon, and said, Pray ye to the Lord for me, that none of these things which ye have spoken come upon me.* Then Simon answered, "Pray to the Lord for me so that nothing you have said may happen to me."
- 25 *And they, when they had testified and preached the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem, and preached the gospel in many villages of the Samaritans.* After they had further proclaimed the word of the Lord and testified about Jesus, Peter and John returned to Jerusalem, preaching the gospel in many Samaritan villages.

- 26 *And the angel of the Lord spake unto Philip, saying, Arise, and go toward the south unto the way that goeth down from Jerusalem unto Gaza, which is desert.* Now an angel of the Lord said to Philip, "Go south to the road — the desert road — that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza."
- 27 *And he arose and went: and, behold, a man of Ethiopia, an eunuch of great authority under Candace queen of the Ethiopians, who had the charge of all her treasure, and had come to Jerusalem for to worship,* So he started out, and on his way he met an Ethiopian eunuch, an important official in charge of all the treasury of the Kandake — queen of the Ethiopians. He had gone to Jerusalem to worship,
- 28 *Was returning, and sitting in his chariot read Esaias the prophet.* and on his way home was sitting in his chariot reading the book of Isaiah the prophet.
- 29 *Then the Spirit said unto Philip, Go near, and join thyself to this chariot.* The Spirit told Philip, "Go to that chariot and stay near it."
- 30 *And Philip ran thither to him, and heard him read the prophet Esaias, and said, Understandest thou what thou readeſt?* Then Philip ran up to the chariot and heard the man reading Isaiah the prophet. "Do you understand what you are reading?" Philip asked.
- 31 *And he said, How can I, except some man should guide me? And he desired Philip that he would come up and sit with him.* "How can I," he said, "unless someone explains it to me?" So he invited Philip to come up and sit with him.
- 32 *The place of the scripture which he read was this, He was led as a sheep to the slaughter; and like a lamb dumb before his shearer, so opened he not his mouth:* This is the passage of Scripture the eunuch was reading: "He was led like a sheep to the slaughter, and as a lamb before its shearer is silent, so he did not open his mouth."
- 33 *In his humiliation his judgment was taken away: and who shall declare his generation? for his life is taken from the earth.* "In His humiliation He was deprived of justice. Who can speak of His descendants? For His life was taken from the earth."

- 34 *And the eunuch answered Philip, and said, I pray thee, of whom speaketh the prophet this? of himself, or of some other man?* The eunuch asked Philip, "Tell me, please, who is the prophet talking about — himself or someone else?"
- 35 *Then Philip opened his mouth, and began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus.* Then Philip began with that very passage of Scripture and told Him the good news about Jesus.
- 36 *And as they went on their way, they came unto a certain water: and the eunuch said, See, here is water; what doth hinder me to be baptized?* As they traveled along the road, they came to some water and the eunuch said, "Look, here is water. What prevents me from being baptized?"
- 37 *And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.* Philip said, "If you believe with all your heart, you may." The eunuch answered, "I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God."
- 38 *And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down both into the water, both Philip and the eunuch; and he baptized him.* He gave orders to stop the chariot. Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water and Philip baptized him.
- 39 *And when they were come up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord caught away Philip, that the eunuch saw him no more: and he went on his way rejoicing.* When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord suddenly took Philip away, and the eunuch did not see him again, but went on His way rejoicing.
- 40 *But Philip was found at Azotus: and passing through he preached in all the cities, till he came to Caesarea.* Philip, however, appeared at Azotus and traveled through that region, preaching the gospel in all the towns until he reached Caesarea.

Words in this chapter:

Samaritans (*sah-MEHR-ih-tanz*) — People of mixed descent who lived in Samaria after the Assyrian conquest — Jews despised them as half-breeds who had corrupted their religion; Jesus's parable of the Good Samaritan shocked His audience.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his

name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 22:20; Dan 3:16-18; Acts 7:58; Acts 5:40; Luke 11:49-50
- v3 — 1 Tim 1:13; Gal 1:13; 1 Cor 15:9; Phil 3:6
- v9 — Acts 13:6; Acts 5:36; John 7:18; Ex 8:18-19
- v16 — Acts 2:38; Acts 19:2; Matt 28:19; Acts 19:5-6
- v17 — Acts 19:6; Acts 6:6; 2 Tim 1:6; Acts 8:18
- v20 — Dan 5:17; Matt 10:8; Acts 2:38; Rev 18:15; Jas 5:3
- v26 — Acts 5:19; Heb 1:14; 2 Kgs 1:3; Acts 27:23; Acts 12:23
- v27 — Ps 68:31; Zeph 3:10; Ps 87:4; Jer 38:7; Isa 56:3-8
- v31 — Rom 10:14; Ps 73:16-17; Isa 29:18-19; Prov 30:2-3; Ps 25:8-9
- v32 — Isa 53:7-8; 1 Pet 2:21-24; Jer 51:40; Jer 11:19; Rom 8:36
- v33 — Isa 53:12; Isa 53:8; Phil 2:8-9; Zech 13:7
- v39 — 1 Kgs 18:12; 2 Kgs 2:16; Ezek 8:3; Ezek 43:5; Ezek 11:1

Chapter 9

Saul was struck down by a light from heaven on the road to Damascus, and the Lord Jesus spoke to him directly. Ananias laid hands on him, his sight was restored, and he was baptized. Saul immediately began preaching Christ in the synagogues, and the disciples in Jerusalem eventually accepted him through Barnabas.

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| 1 | <i>And Saul, yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went unto the high priest,</i> | Meanwhile, Saul was still threatening to kill the Lord's disciples. He went to the high priest |
| 2 | <i>And desired of him letters to Damascus to the synagogues, that if he found any of this way, whether they were men or women, he might bring them bound unto Jerusalem.</i> | and asked him for letters to the synagogues in Damascus, so that if he found any there who belonged to the Way — whether men or women — he might take them as prisoners to Jerusalem. |
| 3 | <i>And as he journeyed, he came near Damascus: and suddenly there shined round about him a light from heaven:</i> | As he neared Damascus on his journey, suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him. |
| 4 | <i>And he fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?</i> | He fell to the ground and heard a voice say to him, "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute Me?" |

- 5 *And he said, Who art thou, Lord? And the Lord said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest: it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.* "Who are You, Lord?" Saul asked. "I am Jesus, whom You are persecuting," He replied. "It is hard for You to kick against the goads."
- 6 *And he trembling and astonished said, Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou must do.* Trembling and astonished, Saul asked, "Lord, what do you want me to do?" The Lord said to Him, "Get up and go into the city. You will be told what you must do."
- 7 *And the men which journeyed with him stood speechless, hearing a voice, but seeing no man.* The men traveling with Saul stood there speechless; they heard the sound but did not see anyone.
- 8 *And Saul arose from the earth; and when his eyes were opened, he saw no man: but they led him by the hand, and brought him into Damascus.* Saul got up from the ground, but when he opened his eyes he could see nothing. So they led him by the hand into Damascus.
- 9 *And he was three days without sight, and neither did eat nor drink.* For three days he was blind and did not eat or drink anything.
- 10 *And there was a certain disciple at Damascus, named Ananias; and to him said the Lord in a vision, Ananias. And he said, Behold, I am here, Lord.* In Damascus there was a disciple named Ananias. The Lord called to Him in a vision, "Ananias!" "Yes, Lord," He answered.
- 11 *And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the street which is called Straight, and enquire in the house of Judas for one called Saul, of Tarsus: for, behold, he prayeth,* The Lord told Him, "Go to the house of Judas on Straight Street and ask for a man from Tarsus named Saul, for he is praying."
- 12 *And hath seen in a vision a man named Ananias coming in, and putting his hand on him, that he might receive his sight.* "In a vision he has seen a man named Ananias come and place his hands on him to restore his sight."

- 13 *Then Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints at Jerusalem:* "Lord," Ananias answered, "I have heard many reports about this man and all the harm he has done to your people in Jerusalem."
- 14 *And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that call on thy name.* "And he has come here with authority from the chief priests to arrest all who call on Your name."
- 15 *But the Lord said unto him, Go thy way: for he is a chosen vessel unto me, to bear my name before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel:* But the Lord said to Ananias, "Go! This man is My chosen instrument to carry My name before the Gentiles and their kings and before the people of Israel."
- 16 *For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake.* "I will show him how much he must suffer for My name."
- 17 *And Ananias went his way, and entered into the house; and putting his hands on him said, Brother Saul, the Lord, even Jesus, that appeared unto thee in the way as thou camest, hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight, and be filled with the Holy Ghost.* Then Ananias went to the house and entered it. Placing His hands on Saul, he said, "Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus, Who appeared to You on the road as You were coming here, has sent me so that You may see again and be filled with the Holy Ghost."
- 18 *And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight forthwith, and arose, and was baptized.* Immediately, something like scales fell from Saul's eyes, and he could see again. He got up and was baptized.
- 19 *And when he had received meat, he was strengthened. Then was Saul certain days with the disciples which were at Damascus.* After taking some food, he regained his strength. Saul spent several days with the disciples in Damascus.
- 20 *And straightway he preached Christ in the synagogues, that he is the Son of God.* At once He began to preach in the synagogues that Jesus is the Son of God.

- 21 *But all that heard him were amazed, and said; Is not this he that destroyed them which called on this name in Jerusalem, and came hither for that intent, that he might bring them bound unto the chief priests?* All those who heard him were astonished and asked, "Isn't he the man who caused havoc in Jerusalem among those who call on this name? And hasn't he come here to take them as prisoners to the chief priests?"
- 22 *But Saul increased the more in strength, and confounded the Jews which dwelt at Damascus, proving that this is very Christ.* Yet Saul grew more and more powerful and baffled the Jews living in Damascus by proving that Jesus is the Christ.
- 23 *And after that many days were fulfilled, the Jews took counsel to kill him:* After many days had gone by, the Jewish leaders conspired to kill Him.
- 24 *But their laying await was known of Saul. And they watched the gates day and night to kill him.* But Saul learned of their plot. Day and night they kept watch at the city gates in order to kill him.
- 25 *Then the disciples took him by night, and let him down by the wall in a basket.* But his followers took him by night and lowered him in a basket through an opening in the wall.
- 26 *And when Saul was come to Jerusalem, he assayed to join himself to the disciples: but they were all afraid of him, and believed not that he was a disciple.* When Saul arrived in Jerusalem, he tried to join the disciples, but they were all afraid of him, not believing that he really was a disciple.
- 27 *But Barnabas took him, and brought him to the apostles, and declared unto them how he had seen the Lord in the way, and that he had spoken to him, and how he had preached boldly at Damascus in the name of Jesus.* But Barnabas took him and brought him to the apostles. He told them how Saul on his journey had seen the Lord and that the Lord had spoken to Him, and how in Damascus He had preached fearlessly in the name of Jesus.
- 28 *And he was with them coming in and going out at Jerusalem.* So Saul stayed with them and moved about freely in Jerusalem, speaking boldly in the name of the Lord.

- 29 *And he spake boldly in the name of the Lord Jesus, and disputed against the Grecians: but they went about to slay him.* He talked and debated with the Hellenistic Jews, but they tried to kill him.
- 30 *Which when the brethren knew, they brought him down to Caesarea, and sent him forth to Tarsus.* When the brothers learned of this, they took him down to Caesarea and sent him off to Tarsus.
- 31 *Then had the churches rest throughout all Judaea and Galilee and Samaria, and were edified; and walking in the fear of the Lord, and in the comfort of the Holy Ghost, were multiplied.* Then the church throughout Judaea, Galilee, and Samaria enjoyed a time of peace and was strengthened. Living in the fear of the Lord and encouraged by the Holy Ghost, it increased in numbers.
- 32 *And it came to pass, as Peter passed throughout all quarters, he came down also to the saints which dwelt at Lydda.* As Peter traveled about the country, he went to visit the Lord's people who lived at Lydda.
- 33 *And there he found a certain man named Aeneas, which had kept his bed eight years, and was sick of the palsy.* There he found a man named Aeneas, who had been paralyzed and bedridden for eight years.
- 34 *And Peter said unto him, Aeneas, Jesus Christ maketh thee whole: arise, and make thy bed. And he arose immediately.* "Aeneas," Peter said to him, "Jesus Christ heals You. Get up and roll up Your mat." Immediately Aeneas got up.
- 35 *And all that dwelt at Lydda and Saron saw him, and turned to the Lord.* All those who lived in Lydda and Sharon saw Him and turned to the Lord.
- 36 *Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named Tabitha, which by interpretation is called Dorcas: this woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did.* In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha — which in Greek is Dorcas. She was always doing good and helping the poor.

- 37 *And it came to pass in those days, that she was sick, and died: whom when they had washed, they laid her in an upper chamber.* About that time she became sick and died. Her body was washed and placed in an upstairs room.
- 38 *And forasmuch as Lydda was nigh to Joppa, and the disciples had heard that Peter was there, they sent unto him two men, desiring him that he would not delay to come to them.* Lydda was near Joppa; so when the disciples heard that Peter was in Lydda, they sent two men to him and urged him, "Please come at once!"
- 39 *Then Peter arose and went with them. When he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber: and all the widows stood by him weeping, and shewing the coats and garments which Dorcas made, while she was with them.* Peter went with them, and when he arrived he was taken upstairs to the room. All the widows stood around him, crying and showing him the robes and other clothing that Dorcas had made while she was still with them.
- 40 *But Peter put them all forth, and kneeled down, and prayed; and turning him to the body said, Tabitha, arise. And she opened her eyes: and when she saw Peter, she sat up.* Peter sent them all out of the room; then he got down on his knees and prayed. Turning toward the dead woman, he said, "Tabitha, get up." She opened her eyes, and seeing Peter she sat up.
- 41 *And he gave her his hand, and lifted her up, and when he had called the saints and widows, presented her alive.* He took her by the hand and helped her to her feet. Then he called the believers and the widows and presented her to them alive.
- 42 *And it was known throughout all Joppa; and many believed in the Lord.* This became known all over Joppa, and many people believed in the Lord.
- 43 *And it came to pass, that he tarried many days in Joppa with one Simon a tanner.* Peter stayed in Joppa for some time with a tanner named Simon.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Ananias (*an-ah-NY-as*) — Several NT figures share this name — notably the disciple who laid hands on Saul of Tarsus after his conversion, restoring his sight; also the man who lied to the Holy Spirit in Acts 5.

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Saul (*SAWL*) — Israel's first king, from the tribe of Benjamin — tall and impressive; disobeyed God and was rejected; God chose David to replace him; his name means 'asked for.'

Galilee (*GAL-ih-lee*) — The northern region of Israel — where Jesus grew up and performed most of His ministry; the disciples were mostly Galileans.

Samaria (*sah-MAIR-ee-ah*) — The capital of the northern kingdom of Israel — built by King Omri; fell to Assyria in 722 BC; in NT times, the region between Judea and Galilee whose people were despised by Jews.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 8:3; 1 Tim 1:13; Gal 1:13; Acts 9:11-21; 1 Cor 15:9
- v2 — Acts 19:23; Acts 19:9; Acts 24:14; Acts 22:4-5; Acts 24:22
- v3 — Acts 26:12-13; 1 Cor 15:8; Acts 22:6; Rev 21:23; 1 Tim 6:16
- v4 — Zech 2:8; 1 Cor 12:12; Gen 22:11; Isa 63:9; Rom 11:22
- v7 — Acts 22:9; Dan 10:7; Acts 26:13-14; John 12:29; Matt 24:40-41
- v8 — Acts 22:11; Acts 9:18; 2 Kgs 6:17-20
- v11 — Acts 9:30; Luke 11:9-10; Acts 11:25; Acts 21:39; Acts 22:3
- v15 — Gal 1:15-16; Eph 3:7-8; 2 Tim 4:16-17; Rom 11:13; Acts 26:17-20
- v16 — 1 Thess 3:3; Acts 21:11; 2 Cor 6:4; 2 Tim 1:12; John 15:20
- v22 — Acts 18:5; Luke 21:15; Isa 40:29; Acts 18:27-28
- v31 — Ps 111:10; John 14:16-18; Isa 33:6; Prov 23:17; Prov 14:26-27
- v36 — Titus 3:8; Titus 2:7; 2 Chr 2:16; Heb 13:21; Acts 10:31

Chapter 10

The centurion Cornelius received a vision from God directing him to send for Peter, and Peter received a vision declaring all foods clean. Peter went to Cornelius's house and preached the gospel, and the Holy Ghost fell on the Gentiles, who spoke in tongues and were baptized.

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| <p>1 <i>There was a certain man in Caesarea called Cornelius, a centurion of the band called the Italian band,</i></p> | <p>At Caesarea there was a man named Cornelius, a centurion in what was known as the Italian Regiment.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cornelius** (cor-NEE-lee-us) — "horn" — A Roman centurion stationed at Caesarea, described as devout and God-fearing. He became the first Gentile convert recorded in Acts, marking a turning point in the mission of the church to all nations.

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| 2 | <i>A devout man, and one that feared God with all his house, which gave much alms to the people, and prayed to God alway.</i> | He and all his household were devout and God-fearing; He gave generously to those in need and prayed to God regularly. |
| 3 | <i>He saw in a vision evidently about the ninth hour of the day an angel of God coming in to him, and saying unto him, Cornelius.</i> | One day at about three in the afternoon He had a vision. He distinctly saw an angel of God, Who came to Him and said, "Cornelius!" |
| 4 | <i>And when he looked on him, he was afraid, and said, What is it, Lord? And he said unto him, Thy prayers and thine alms are come up for a memorial before God.</i> | Cornelius stared at him in fear. "What is it, Lord?" he asked. The angel answered, "Your prayers and gifts to the poor have come up as a memorial offering before God." |
| 5 | <i>And now send men to Joppa, and call for one Simon, whose surname is Peter:</i> | "Now send men to Joppa to bring back a man named Simon who is called Peter." |
| 6 | <i>He lodgeth with one Simon a tanner, whose house is by the sea side: he shall tell thee what thou oughtest to do.</i> | "He is staying with Simon the tanner, whose house is by the sea." |
| 7 | <i>And when the angel which spake unto Cornelius was departed, he called two of his household servants, and a devout soldier of them that waited on him continually;</i> | When the angel who spoke to him had gone, Cornelius called two of his servants and a devout soldier who was one of his attendants. |
| 8 | <i>And when he had declared all these things unto them, he sent them to Joppa.</i> | He told them everything that had happened and sent them to Joppa. |
| 9 | <i>On the morrow, as they went on their journey, and drew nigh unto the city, Peter went up upon the housetop to pray about the sixth hour:</i> | About noon the following day, as the men were on their journey and approaching the city, Peter went up on the roof to pray. |

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| 10 <i>And he became very hungry, and would have eaten: but while they made ready, he fell into a trance,</i> | He became hungry and wanted something to eat, and while the meal was being prepared, he fell into a trance. |
| 11 <i>And saw heaven opened, and a certain vessel descending unto him, as it had been a great sheet knit at the four corners, and let down to the earth:</i> | He saw heaven opened and something like a large sheet being let down to earth by its four corners. |
| 12 <i>Wherein were all manner of fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.</i> | It contained all kinds of four-footed animals, as well as reptiles and birds. |
| 13 <i>And there came a voice to him, Rise, Peter; kill, and eat.</i> | Then a voice told him, "Get up, Peter. Kill and eat." |
| 14 <i>But Peter said, Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten any thing that is common or unclean.</i> | "Surely not, Lord!" Peter replied. "I have never eaten anything impure or unclean." |
| 15 <i>And the voice spake unto him again the second time, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.</i> | The voice spoke to him a second time: "Do not call anything impure that God has made clean." |
| 16 <i>This was done thrice: and the vessel was received up again into heaven.</i> | This happened three times, and immediately the sheet was taken back to heaven. |
| 17 <i>Now while Peter doubted in himself what this vision which he had seen should mean, behold, the men which were sent from Cornelius had made enquiry for Simon's house, and stood before the gate,</i> | While Peter was wondering about the meaning of the vision, the men sent by Cornelius found out where Simon's house was and stopped at the gate. |
| 18 <i>And called, and asked whether Simon, which was surnamed Peter, were lodged there.</i> | They called out, asking if Simon who was known as Peter was staying there. |

- 19 *While Peter thought on the vision, the Spirit said unto him, Behold, three men seek thee.* While Peter was still thinking about the vision, the Spirit said to Him, "Three men are looking for You."
- 20 *Arise therefore, and get thee down, and go with them, doubting nothing: for I have sent them.* "Get up and go downstairs. Do not hesitate to go with them, for I have sent them."
- 21 *Then Peter went down to the men which were sent unto him from Cornelius; and said, Behold, I am he whom ye seek: what is the cause wherefore ye are come?* Peter went down and said to the men, "I'm the one you're looking for. Why have you come?"
- 22 *And they said, Cornelius the centurion, a just man, and one that feareth God, and of good report among all the nation of the Jews, was warned from God by an holy angel to send for thee into his house, and to hear words of thee.* The men replied, "We have come from Cornelius the centurion. He is a righteous and God-fearing man, who is respected by all the Jewish people. A holy angel told Him to ask you to come to His house so that He could hear what you have to say."
- 23 *Then called he them in, and lodged them. And on the morrow Peter went away with them, and certain brethren from Joppa accompanied him.* Then Peter invited the men into the house to be his guests. The next day Peter started out with them, and some of the believers from Joppa went along.
- 24 *And the morrow after they entered into Caesarea. And Cornelius waited for them, and had called together his kinsmen and near friends.* The following day he arrived in Caesarea. Cornelius was expecting them and had called together his relatives and close friends.
- 25 *And as Peter was coming in, Cornelius met him, and fell down at his feet, and worshipped him.* As Peter entered the house, Cornelius met him and fell at his feet in reverence.
- 26 *But Peter took him up, saying, Stand up; I myself also am a man.* But Peter made him get up. "Stand up," he said, "I am only a man myself."

- 27 *And as he talked with him, he went in, and found many that were come together.* While talking with him, Peter went inside and found a large gathering of people.
- 28 *And he said unto them, Ye know how that it is an unlawful thing for a man that is a Jew to keep company, or come unto one of another nation; but God hath shewed me that I should not call any man common or unclean.* He said to them: "You are well aware that it is against our law for a Jew to associate with or visit a Gentile. But God has shown me that I should not call anyone impure or unclean."
- 29 *Therefore came I unto you without gainsaying, as soon as I was sent for: I ask therefore for what intent ye have sent for me?* "So when I was sent for, I came without raising any objection. May I ask why you sent for me?"
- 30 *And Cornelius said, Four days ago I was fasting until this hour; and at the ninth hour I prayed in my house, and, behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing,* Cornelius answered: "Four days ago I was fasting until this hour. At three in the afternoon I was praying in my house, when suddenly a man in shining clothes stood before me
- 31 *And said, Cornelius, thy prayer is heard, and thine alms are had in remembrance in the sight of God.* and said, 'Cornelius, God has heard your prayer and remembered your gifts to the poor.'"
- 32 *Send therefore to Joppa, and call hither Simon, whose surname is Peter; he is lodged in the house of one Simon a tanner by the sea side: who, when he cometh, shall speak unto thee.* "'Send to Joppa for Simon who is called Peter. He is a guest in the home of Simon the tanner, who lives by the sea.'"
- 33 *Immediately therefore I sent to thee; and thou hast well done that thou art come. Now therefore are we all here present before God, to hear all things that are commanded thee of God.* "So I sent for you immediately, and it was good of you to come. Now we are all here in the presence of God to listen to everything the Lord has commanded you to tell us."
- 34 *Then Peter opened his mouth, and said, Of a truth I perceive that God is no respecter of persons:* Then Peter began to speak: "I now truly see that God shows no favoritism,"

- 35 *But in every nation he that feareth him, and worketh righteousness, is accepted with him.* "but accepts from every nation the one who fears him and does what is right."
- 36 *The word which God sent unto the children of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ: (he is Lord of all:)* "You know the message God sent to the people of Israel, announcing the good news of peace through Jesus Christ, Who is Lord of all."
- 37 *That word, I say, ye know, which was published throughout all Judaea, and began from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached;* "You know what has happened throughout the province of Judaea, beginning in Galilee after the baptism that John preached —"
- 38 *How God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Ghost and with power: who went about doing good, and healing all that were oppressed of the devil; for God was with him.* "how God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Ghost and power, and how He went around doing good and healing all who were under the power of the devil, because God was with Him."
- 39 *And we are witnesses of all things which he did both in the land of the Jews, and in Jerusalem; whom they slew and hanged on a tree:* "We are witnesses of everything He did in the country of the Jews and in Jerusalem. They killed Him by hanging Him on a tree,"
- 40 *Him God raised up the third day, and shewed him openly;* "but God raised Him from the dead on the third day and caused Him to be seen."
- 41 *Not to all the people, but unto witnesses chosen before of God, even to us, who did eat and drink with him after he rose from the dead.* "He was not seen by all the people, but by witnesses whom God had already chosen — by us who ate and drank with Him after He rose from the dead."
- 42 *And he commanded us to preach unto the people, and to testify that it is he which was ordained of God to be the Judge of quick and dead.* "He commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that he is the one whom God appointed as judge of the living and the dead."

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| <p>43 <i>To him give all the prophets witness, that through his name whosoever believeth in him shall receive remission of sins.</i></p> <p>44 <i>While Peter yet spake these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word.</i></p> <p>45 <i>And they of the circumcision which believed were astonished, as many as came with Peter, because that on the Gentiles also was poured out the gift of the Holy Ghost.</i></p> <p>46 <i>For they heard them speak with tongues, and magnify God. Then answered Peter,</i></p> <p>47 <i>Can any man forbid water, that these should not be baptized, which have received the Holy Ghost as well as we?</i></p> <p>48 <i>And he commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord. Then prayed they him to tarry certain days.</i></p> | <p>"All the prophets testify about Him that everyone who believes in Him receives forgiveness of sins through His name."</p> <p>While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all who heard the message.</p> <p>The circumcised believers who had come with Peter were astonished that the gift of the Holy Ghost had been poured out even on Gentiles.</p> <p>For they heard them speaking in tongues and praising God. Then Peter said,</p> <p>"Surely no one can stand in the way of their being baptized with water. They have received the Holy Ghost just as we have."</p> <p>So He ordered that they be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ. Then they asked Peter to stay with them for a few days.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

centurion (*sen-TYUR-ee-un*) — A Roman army officer commanding approximately 100 soldiers — several centurions in the NT show unusual faith in Jesus.

Cornelius (*kor-NEE-lee-us*) — A Roman centurion described as devout and God-fearing — the first Gentile to receive the Holy Spirit through Peter's preaching; key figure in opening the gospel to non-Jews.

Cross-References:

v2 — Matt 7:7-8; Acts 10:4; Acts 10:22; Acts 10:35; Acts 13:16

v4 — Phil 4:6; Heb 6:10; Acts 10:31; Mal 3:16; Ps 141:2

v15 — 1 Cor 10:25; Titus 1:15; Matt 15:11; Mark 7:19; Rom 14:14

v31 — Acts 10:4; Luke 1:13; Dan 9:23; Isa 38:5; Rev 8:3-4

- v34 — Rom 2:11; 2 Chr 19:7; Deut 10:17; Col 3:25; Job 34:19
 v35 — 1 John 2:29; Rom 10:12-13; Acts 10:2; Acts 15:9; Col 3:11
 v38 — Luke 4:18; Acts 2:22; Isa 61:1-3; Isa 11:2; John 3:34
 v42 — 2 Cor 5:10; 1 Pet 4:5; 2 Tim 4:1; Rom 14:9-10; Acts 17:31
 v43 — Zech 13:1; Acts 2:38; Isa 53:11; Jer 31:34; Rom 10:11
 v44 — Acts 11:15; Acts 19:6; Acts 15:8; Acts 4:31
 v46 — Acts 2:4; Acts 19:6; Mark 16:17; 1 Cor 14:20-25; Acts 2:11
 v47 — Acts 8:36; Acts 11:15-17; Rom 10:12; Acts 15:8-9

Chapter 11

Peter reported to the Jerusalem church how God gave the Holy Ghost to the Gentiles, and the brethren glorified God, saying He had also granted repentance to the Gentiles. The scattered believers preached the word as far as Antioch, where Barnabas and Saul taught a great number, and the disciples were first called Christians.

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| 1 <i>And the apostles and brethren that were in Judaea heard that the Gentiles had also received the word of God.</i> | The apostles and the believers throughout Judaea heard that the Gentiles also had received the word of God. |
| 2 <i>And when Peter was come up to Jerusalem, they that were of the circumcision contended with him,</i> | So when Peter went up to Jerusalem, the circumcised believers criticized him |
| 3 <i>Saying, Thou wentest in to men uncircumcised, and didst eat with them.</i> | and said, "You went into the house of uncircumcised men and ate with them." |
| 4 <i>But Peter rehearsed the matter from the beginning, and expounded it by order unto them, saying,</i> | Starting from the beginning, Peter explained everything to them precisely as it had happened. |
| 5 <i>I was in the city of Joppa praying: and in a trance I saw a vision, A certain vessel descend, as it had been a great sheet, let down from heaven by four corners; and it came even to me:</i> | "I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision. I saw something like a large sheet being let down from heaven by its four corners, and it came down to where I was." |

- 6 *Upon the which when I had fastened mine eyes, I considered, and saw fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.* "I looked into it and saw four-footed animals of the earth, wild animals, reptiles, and birds."
- 7 *And I heard a voice saying unto me, Arise, Peter; slay and eat.* "Then I heard a voice telling me, 'Get up, Peter. Kill and eat.'"
- 8 *But I said, Not so, Lord: for nothing common or unclean hath at any time entered into my mouth.* "'Surely not, Lord!' I replied. 'Nothing impure or unclean has ever entered my mouth.'"
- 9 *But the voice answered me again from heaven, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.* "The voice spoke from heaven a second time: 'Do not call anything impure that God has made clean.'"
- 10 *And this was done three times: and all were drawn up again into heaven.* "This happened three times, and then it was all pulled up to heaven again."
- 11 *And, behold, immediately there were three men already come unto the house where I was, sent from Caesarea unto me.* "Right then three men who had been sent to me from Caesarea stopped at the house where I was staying."
- 12 *And the Spirit bade me go with them, nothing doubting. Moreover these six brethren accompanied me, and we entered into the man's house:* "The Spirit told me to have no hesitation about going with them. These six brothers also went with me, and we entered the man's house."
- 13 *And he shewed us how he had seen an angel in his house, which stood and said unto him, Send men to Joppa, and call for Simon, whose surname is Peter;* "He told us how he had seen an angel appear in his house and say, 'Send to Joppa for Simon who is called Peter.'"
- 14 *Who shall tell thee words, whereby thou and all thy house shall be saved.* "'He will bring you a message through which you and all your household will be saved.'"
- 15 *And as I began to speak, the Holy Ghost fell on them, as on us at the beginning.* "As I began to speak, the Holy Ghost came on them as He had come on us at the beginning."

- 16 *Then remembered I the word of the Lord, how that he said, John indeed baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost.* "Then I remembered what the Lord had said: 'John baptized with water, but you will be baptized with the Holy Ghost.'"
- 17 *Forasmuch then as God gave them the like gift as he did unto us, who believed on the Lord Jesus Christ; what was I, that I could withstand God?* "So if God gave them the same gift He gave us who believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, Who was I to think that I could stand in God's way?"
- 18 *When they heard these things, they held their peace, and glorified God, saying, Then hath God also to the Gentiles granted repentance unto life.* When they heard this, they had no further objections and praised God, saying, "So then, God has granted even the Gentiles repentance to life."
- 19 *Now they which were scattered abroad upon the persecution that arose about Stephen travelled as far as Phenice, and Cyprus, and Antioch, preaching the word to none but unto the Jews only.* Now those who had been scattered by the persecution that broke out when Stephen was killed traveled as far as Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, spreading the word only among Jews.
- 20 *And some of them were men of Cyprus and Cyrene, which, when they were come to Antioch, spake unto the Grecians, preaching the Lord Jesus.* Some of them, however, men from Cyprus and Cyrene, went to Antioch and began to speak to Greeks also, telling them the good news about the Lord Jesus.
- 21 *And the hand of the Lord was with them: and a great number believed, and turned unto the Lord.* The Lord's hand was with them, and a great number of people believed and turned to the Lord.
- 22 *Then tidings of these things came unto the ears of the church which was in Jerusalem: and they sent forth Barnabas, that he should go as far as Antioch.* News of this reached the church in Jerusalem, and they sent Barnabas to Antioch.

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| 23 | <i>Who, when he came, and had seen the grace of God, was glad, and exhorted them all, that with purpose of heart they would cleave unto the Lord.</i> | When he arrived and saw what the grace of God had done, He was glad and encouraged them all to remain true to the Lord with all their hearts. |
| 24 | <i>For he was a good man, and full of the Holy Ghost and of faith: and much people was added unto the Lord.</i> | He was a good man, full of the Holy Ghost and faith, and a great number of people were brought to the Lord. |
| 25 | <i>Then departed Barnabas to Tarsus, for to seek Saul:</i> | Then Barnabas went to Tarsus to look for Saul. |
| 26 | <i>And when he had found him, he brought him unto Antioch. And it came to pass, that a whole year they assembled themselves with the church, and taught much people. And the disciples were called Christians first in Antioch.</i> | When he found him, he brought him to Antioch. For a whole year Barnabas and Saul met with the church and taught great numbers of people. The disciples were called Christians first at Antioch. |
| 27 | <i>And in these days came prophets from Jerusalem unto Antioch.</i> | During this time some prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch. |
| 28 | <i>And there stood up one of them named Agabus, and signified by the Spirit that there should be great dearth throughout all the world: which came to pass in the days of Claudius Caesar.</i> | One of them, named Agabus, stood up and through the Spirit predicted that a severe famine would spread over the entire Roman world. This happened during the reign of Claudius. |
| 29 | <i>Then the disciples, every man according to his ability, determined to send relief unto the brethren which dwelt in Judaea:</i> | The disciples, as each one was able, decided to provide help for the brothers and sisters living in Judaea. |
| 30 | <i>Which also they did, and sent it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.</i> | This they did, sending their gift to the elders by Barnabas and Saul. |

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

faith — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Cross-References:

v1 — Ps 22:27; Mal 1:11

v12 — Acts 8:29; Rom 3:22

v14 — Acts 16:15; Acts 10:22; Acts 16:31-34

v16 — Acts 1:5; Mark 1:8; Prov 1:23; Matt 3:11; Luke 3:16

v17 — Acts 10:47; Rom 9:20-26

v18 — Rom 10:12-13; 2 Cor 7:10; Ezek 36:26; 2 Tim 2:25-26; Acts 20:21

v21 — Luke 1:66; Acts 2:47

v23 — 1 Cor 15:58; Acts 14:22; 1 John 2:28; Acts 13:43; Deut 30:20

v24 — Acts 11:21; Acts 5:14; Ps 112:5

v26 — 1 Pet 4:16; Acts 26:28; 1 Pet 4:14

v27 — Acts 13:1; 1 Cor 12:28

v30 — Acts 12:25; Acts 14:23

Chapter 12

Herod killed James the brother of John and imprisoned Peter, but an angel of the Lord delivered Peter from prison by night. Herod searched for Peter without success and later accepted divine praise from the crowd at Caesarea; an angel of the Lord struck him, and he was eaten of worms and died.

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| <p>¹ <i>Now about that time Herod the king stretched forth his hands to vex certain of the church.</i></p> | It was about this time that King Herod arrested some who belonged to the church, intending to persecute them. |
| <p>² <i>And he killed James the brother of John with the sword.</i></p> | He had James, the brother of John, put to death with the sword. |
| <p>³ <i>And because he saw it pleased the Jews, he proceeded further to take Peter also. (Then were the days of unleavened bread.)</i></p> | When he saw that this met with approval among the Jews, he proceeded to seize Peter also. This happened during the Festival of Unleavened Bread. |

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| 4 | <i>And when he had apprehended him, he put him in prison, and delivered him to four quaternions of soldiers to keep him; intending after Easter to bring him forth to the people.</i> | After arresting him, he put him in prison, handing him over to be guarded by four squads of four soldiers each. Herod intended to bring him out for public trial after Easter. |
| 5 | <i>Peter therefore was kept in prison: but prayer was made without ceasing of the church unto God for him.</i> | So Peter was kept in prison, but the church was earnestly praying to God for Him. |
| 6 | <i>And when Herod would have brought him forth, the same night Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains: and the keepers before the door kept the prison.</i> | The night before Herod was to bring him to trial, Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains, and sentries stood guard at the entrance. |
| 7 | <i>And, behold, the angel of the Lord came upon him, and a light shined in the prison: and he smote Peter on the side, and raised him up, saying, Arise up quickly. And his chains fell off from his hands.</i> | Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared and a light shone in the cell. He struck Peter on the side and woke him up. "Quick, get up!" he said, and the chains fell off Peter's wrists. |
| 8 | <i>And the angel said unto him, Gird thyself, and bind on thy sandals. And so he did. And he saith unto him, Cast thy garment about thee, and follow me.</i> | Then the angel said to him, "Put on your clothes and sandals." And Peter did so. "Wrap your cloak around you and follow me," the angel told him. |
| 9 | <i>And he went out, and followed him; and wist not that it was true which was done by the angel; but thought he saw a vision.</i> | Peter followed him out of the prison, but he had no idea that what the angel was doing was really happening; he thought he was seeing a vision. |
| 10 | <i>When they were past the first and the second ward, they came unto the iron gate that leadeth unto the city; which opened to them of his own accord: and they went out, and passed on through one street; and forthwith the angel departed from him.</i> | They passed the first and second guards and came to the iron gate leading to the city. It opened for them by itself, and they went through it. When they had walked the length of one street, suddenly the angel left him. |

- 11 *And when Peter was come to himself, he said, Now I know of a surety, that the Lord hath sent his angel, and hath delivered me out of the hand of Herod, and from all the expectation of the people of the Jews.* Then Peter came to himself and said, "Now I know without a doubt that the Lord has sent His angel and rescued me from Herod's clutches and from everything the Jewish people were hoping would happen."
- 12 *And when he had considered the thing, he came to the house of Mary the mother of John, whose surname was Mark; where many were gathered together praying.* When this had dawned on him, he went to the house of Mary the mother of John, also called Mark, where many people had gathered and were praying.
- 13 *And as Peter knocked at the door of the gate, a damsel came to hearken, named Rhoda.* Peter knocked at the outer entrance, and a servant named Rhoda came to answer the door.
- 14 *And when she knew Peter's voice, she opened not the gate for joy, but ran in, and told how Peter stood before the gate.* When she recognized Peter's voice, she was so overjoyed she ran back without opening the door and exclaimed, "Peter is at the door!"
- 15 *And they said unto her, Thou art mad. But she constantly affirmed that it was even so. Then said they, It is his angel.* "You're out of your mind," they told her. When she kept insisting that it was so, they said, "It must be his angel."
- 16 *But Peter continued knocking; and when they had opened the door, and saw him, they were astonished.* But Peter kept on knocking, and when they opened the door and saw him, they were astonished.
- 17 *But he, beckoning unto them with the hand to hold their peace, declared unto them how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. And he said, Go shew these things unto James, and to the brethren. And he departed, and went into another place.* Peter motioned with his hand for them to be quiet and described how the Lord had brought him out of prison. "Tell James and the other brothers and sisters about this," he said, and then he left for another place.
- 18 *Now as soon as it was day, there was no small stir among the soldiers, what was become of Peter.* In the morning, there was no small commotion among the soldiers as to what had become of Peter.

- 19 *And when Herod had sought for him, and found him not, he examined the keepers, and commanded that they should be put to death. And he went down from Judaea to Caesarea, and there abode.* After Herod had a thorough search made for him and did not find him, he cross-examined the guards and ordered that they be executed. Then Herod went from Judaea to Caesarea and stayed there.
- 20 *And Herod was highly displeased with them of Tyre and Sidon: but they came with one accord to him, and, having made Blastus the king's chamberlain their friend, desired peace; because their country was nourished by the king's country.* He had been quarreling with the people of Tyre and Sidon; they now joined together and sought an audience with him. After securing the support of Blastus, a trusted personal servant of the king, they asked for peace, because they depended on the king's country for their food supply.
- 21 *And upon a set day Herod, arrayed in royal apparel, sat upon his throne, and made an oration unto them.* On the appointed day Herod, wearing his royal robes, sat on his throne and delivered a public address to the people.
- 22 *And the people gave a shout, saying, It is the voice of a god, and not of a man.* They shouted, "This is the voice of a god, not of a man."
- 23 *And immediately the angel of the Lord smote him, because he gave not God the glory: and he was eaten of worms, and gave up the ghost.* Immediately, because Herod did not give praise to God, an angel of the Lord struck Him down, and He was eaten by worms and died.
- 24 *But the word of God grew and multiplied.* But the word of God continued to spread and flourish.
- 25 *And Barnabas and Saul returned from Jerusalem, when they had fulfilled their ministry, and took with them John, whose surname was Mark.* When Barnabas and Saul had finished their mission, they returned from Jerusalem, taking with them John, also called Mark.

Words in this chapter:

Herod (HEHR-od) — The Edomite king of Judea appointed by Rome — Herod the Great ordered the massacre of the infants in Bethlehem; later Herods appear throughout the NT.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 24:9; John 15:20; Matt 10:17-18; John 16:2; Luke 22:53
- v2 — Heb 11:37; Matt 4:21-22; Matt 20:23
- v3 — Ex 23:15; Acts 24:27; John 12:43; Lev 23:6-14
- v4 — Prov 19:21; Luke 22:33
- v5 — 1 Cor 12:26; Jas 5:16; 1 Thess 5:17; Eph 6:18-20; 2 Cor 1:11
- v7 — Acts 5:19; Acts 16:26; Ps 146:7; Ps 105:18-20; Ps 142:6-7
- v10 — Acts 5:19; Acts 16:26; Isa 45:1-2
- v11 — Dan 6:22; Dan 3:28; 2 Pet 2:9; Ps 34:7; Ps 97:10
- v12 — 1 John 5:14-15; Acts 12:5; Acts 13:5; Acts 12:25; Isa 65:24
- v17 — Acts 21:40; Acts 13:16; Acts 19:33; Acts 21:18; Acts 15:13
- v23 — Acts 10:25-26; Ps 115:1; 2 Thess 2:4; Acts 14:14-15; Dan 4:30-37
- v24 — Acts 6:7; 2 Thess 3:1; Acts 19:20

Chapter 13

The Holy Ghost sent Barnabas and Saul from Antioch on the first missionary journey, and they sailed to Cyprus where Saul — now called Paul — struck the sorcerer Elymas blind. Paul preached in the synagogue at Antioch in Pisidia, declaring justification by faith in Christ, and many Gentiles believed.

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| 1 | <i>Now there were in the church that was at Antioch certain prophets and teachers; as Barnabas, and Simeon that was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene, and Manaen, which had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.</i> | Now in the church at Antioch there were prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen who had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, and Saul. |
| 2 | <i>As they ministered to the Lord, and fasted, the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.</i> | While they were worshiping the Lord and fasting, the Holy Ghost said, "Set apart for Me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them." |
| 3 | <i>And when they had fasted and prayed, and laid their hands on them, they sent them away.</i> | So after they had fasted and prayed, they placed their hands on them and sent them off. |
| 4 | <i>So they, being sent forth by the Holy Ghost, departed unto Seleucia; and from thence they sailed to Cyprus.</i> | The two of them, sent on their way by the Holy Ghost, went down to Seleucia and sailed from there to Cyprus. |

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| <p>5 <i>And when they were at Salamis, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews: and they had also John to their minister.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And when they had gone through the isle unto Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Barjesus:</i></p> <p>7 <i>Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his name by interpretation) withstood them, seeking to turn away the deputy from the faith.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost, set his eyes on him,</i></p> | <p>When they arrived at Salamis, they proclaimed the word of God in the Jewish synagogues. John was with them as their helper.</p> <p>They traveled through the whole island until they came to Paphos. There they met a Jewish sorcerer and false prophet named Bar-Jesus,</p> <p>who was an attendant of the proconsul, Sergius Paulus. The proconsul, an intelligent man, sent for Barnabas and Saul because he wanted to hear the word of God.</p> <p>But Elymas the sorcerer — for that is what his name means — opposed them and tried to turn the proconsul from the faith.</p> <p>Then Saul, who was also called Paul, filled with the Holy Ghost, looked straight at Elymas</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Paul** (PAWL) — "small" or "humble" — The apostle formerly known as Saul of Tarsus. A Pharisee who had persecuted the church, Paul was dramatically converted on the road to Damascus (Acts 9). He became the greatest missionary of the early church, author of thirteen New Testament epistles, and the apostle to the Gentiles.

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| <p>10 <i>And said, O full of all subtilty and all mischief, thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness, wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?</i></p> | <p>and said, "You are a child of the devil and an enemy of everything that is right! You are full of all kinds of deceit and trickery. Will you never stop perverting the right ways of the Lord?"</p> |
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- 11 *And now, behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season. And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.* "Now the hand of the Lord is against you. You are going to be blind for a time, not even able to see the light of the sun." Immediately mist and darkness came over Him, and He groped about, seeking someone to lead him by the hand.
- 12 *Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.* When the proconsul saw what had happened, he believed, for he was amazed at the teaching about the Lord.
- 13 *Now when Paul and his company loosed from Paphos, they came to Perga in Pamphylia: and John departing from them returned to Jerusalem.* From Paphos, Paul and his companions sailed to Perga in Pamphylia, where John left them to return to Jerusalem.
- 14 *But when they departed from Perga, they came to Antioch in Pisidia, and went into the synagogue on the sabbath day, and sat down.* From Perga they went on to Antioch in Pisidia. On the Sabbath they entered the synagogue and sat down.
- 15 *And after the reading of the law and the prophets the rulers of the synagogue sent unto them, saying, Ye men and brethren, if ye have any word of exhortation for the people, say on.* After the reading from the Law and the Prophets, the leaders of the synagogue sent word to them, saying, "Brothers, if you have a word of exhortation for the people, please speak."
- 16 *Then Paul stood up, and beckoning with his hand said, Men of Israel, and ye that fear God, give audience.* Standing up, Paul motioned with his hand and said: "Fellow Israelites and you Gentiles who worship God, listen to me."
- 17 *The God of this people of Israel chose our fathers, and exalted the people when they dwelt as strangers in the land of Egypt, and with an high arm brought he them out of it.* "The God of the people of Israel chose our ancestors; he made the people prosper during their stay in Egypt and with mighty power He led them out of that country."

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| 18 <i>And about the time of forty years suffered he their manners in the wilderness.</i> | "For about forty years He endured their conduct in the wilderness." |
| 19 <i>And when he had destroyed seven nations in the land of Chanaan, he divided their land to them by lot.</i> | "And when He had destroyed seven nations in Canaan, He gave their land to His people as their inheritance." |
| 20 <i>And after that he gave unto them judges about the space of four hundred and fifty years, until Samuel the prophet.</i> | "All this took about 450 years. After this, God gave them judges until the time of Samuel the prophet." |
| 21 <i>And afterward they desired a king: and God gave unto them Saul the son of Cis, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, by the space of forty years.</i> | "Then the people asked for a king, and he gave them Saul son of Kish, of the tribe of Benjamin, who ruled for forty years." |
| 22 <i>And when he had removed him, he raised up unto them David to be their king; to whom also he gave testimony, and said, I have found David the son of Jesse, a man after mine own heart, which shall fulfil all my will.</i> | "After removing Saul, he made David their king. God testified concerning Him: 'I have found David son of Jesse, a man after My own heart; he will do everything I want him to do.'" |
| 23 <i>Of this man's seed hath God according to his promise raised unto Israel a Saviour, Jesus:</i> | "From this man's descendants God has brought to Israel the Savior Jesus, as He promised." |
| 24 <i>When John had first preached before his coming the baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel.</i> | "Before the coming of Jesus, John preached repentance and baptism to all the people of Israel." |
| 25 <i>And as John fulfilled his course, he said, Whom think ye that I am? I am not he. But, behold, there cometh one after me, whose shoes of his feet I am not worthy to loose.</i> | "As John was completing his work, he said: 'Who do you suppose I am? I am not the one You are looking for. But there is someone coming after me whose sandals I am not worthy to untie.'" |

- 26 *Men and brethren, children of the stock of Abraham, and whosoever among you feareth God, to you is the word of this salvation sent.* "Fellow children of Abraham and you God-fearing Gentiles, it is to us that this message of salvation has been sent."
- 27 *For they that dwell at Jerusalem, and their rulers, because they knew him not, nor yet the voices of the prophets which are read every sabbath day, they have fulfilled them in condemning him.* "The people of Jerusalem and their rulers did not recognize Jesus, yet in condemning Him they fulfilled the words of the prophets that are read every Sabbath."
- 28 *And though they found no cause of death in him, yet desired they Pilate that he should be slain.* "Though they found no proper ground for a death sentence, they asked Pilate to have him executed."
- 29 *And when they had fulfilled all that was written of him, they took him down from the tree, and laid him in a sepulchre.* "When they had carried out all that was written about Him, they took Him down from the tree and laid Him in a tomb."
- 30 *But God raised him from the dead:* "But God raised him from the dead,"
- 31 *And he was seen many days of them which came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who are his witnesses unto the people.* "and for many days He was seen by those who had traveled with Him from Galilee to Jerusalem. They are now His witnesses to our people."
- 32 *And we declare unto you glad tidings, how that the promise which was made unto the fathers,* "We tell you the good news: what God promised our ancestors
- 33 *God hath fulfilled the same unto us their children, in that he hath raised up Jesus again; as it is also written in the second psalm, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee.* He has fulfilled for us, their children, by raising up Jesus. As it is written in the second Psalm: 'You are My Son; today have I begotten You.'"

- 34 *And as concerning that he raised him up from the dead, now no more to return to corruption, he said on this wise, I will give you the sure mercies of David.* "God raised him from the dead so that He will never be subject to decay. As God has said, 'I will give you the sure mercies of David.'"
- 35 *Wherefore he saith also in another psalm, Thou shalt not suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.* "So it is also stated elsewhere: 'You will not let your Holy One see decay.'"
- 36 *For David, after he had served his own generation by the will of God, fell on sleep, and was laid unto his fathers, and saw corruption:* "Now when David had served God's purpose in His own generation, He fell asleep; He was buried with His ancestors and His body decayed."
- 37 *But he, whom God raised again, saw no corruption.* "But the One whom God raised from the dead did not see decay."
- 38 *Be it known unto you therefore, men and brethren, that through this man is preached unto you the forgiveness of sins:* "Therefore, my friends, I want You to know that through Jesus the forgiveness of sins is proclaimed to You."
- 39 *And by him all that believe are justified from all things, from which ye could not be justified by the law of Moses.* "Through Him everyone who believes is justified from everything you could not be justified from by the law of Moses."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Justified** (JUS-tih-fyde) — declared not guilty by God; legally counted as righteous because of Christ. Justification is not being made righteous by our actions — it is God the Judge pronouncing us "not guilty" because Jesus paid our penalty.

- 40 *Beware therefore, lest that come upon you, which is spoken of in the prophets;* "Take care that what the prophets have said does not happen to You:"
- 41 *Behold, ye despisers, and wonder, and perish: for I work a work in your days, a work which ye shall in no wise believe, though a man declare it unto you.* "'Look, You scoffers, wonder and perish, for I am going to do something in your days that you would never believe, even if someone told you.'"

- 42 *And when the Jews were gone out of the synagogue, the Gentiles besought that these words might be preached to them the next sabbath.* As Paul and Barnabas were leaving the synagogue, the people invited them to speak further about these things on the next Sabbath.
- 43 *Now when the congregation was broken up, many of the Jews and religious proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas: who, speaking to them, persuaded them to continue in the grace of God.* When the congregation was dismissed, many of the Jews and devout converts to Judaism followed Paul and Barnabas, who talked with them and urged them to continue in the grace of God.
- 44 *And the next sabbath day came almost the whole city together to hear the word of God.* On the next Sabbath almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord.
- 45 *But when the Jews saw the multitudes, they were filled with envy, and spake against those things which were spoken by Paul, contradicting and blaspheming.* When the Jews saw the crowds, they were filled with jealousy. They began to contradict what Paul was saying and heaped abuse on him.
- 46 *Then Paul and Barnabas waxed bold, and said, It was necessary that the word of God should first have been spoken to you: but seeing ye put it from you, and judge yourselves unworthy of everlasting life, lo, we turn to the Gentiles.* Then Paul and Barnabas answered them boldly: "We had to speak the word of God to you first. Since you reject it and do not consider yourselves worthy of eternal life, we now turn to the Gentiles."
- 47 *For so hath the Lord commanded us, saying, I have set thee to be a light of the Gentiles, that thou shouldest be for salvation unto the ends of the earth.* "For this is what the Lord has commanded us: 'I have made you a light for the Gentiles, that you may bring salvation to the ends of the earth.'"
- 48 *And when the Gentiles heard this, they were glad, and glorified the word of the Lord: and as many as were ordained to eternal life believed.* When the Gentiles heard this, they were glad and honored the word of the Lord; and all who were appointed for eternal life believed.

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| 49 | <i>And the word of the Lord was published throughout all the region.</i> | The word of the Lord spread through the whole region. |
| 50 | <i>But the Jews stirred up the devout and honourable women, and the chief men of the city, and raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and expelled them out of their coasts.</i> | But the Jewish leaders stirred up the God-fearing women of high standing and the leading men of the city. They stirred up persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and expelled them from their region. |
| 51 | <i>But they shook off the dust of their feet against them, and came unto Iconium.</i> | So they shook the dust off their feet as a warning to them and went to Iconium. |
| 52 | <i>And the disciples were filled with joy, and with the Holy Ghost.</i> | And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Ghost. |

Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 4:36; Acts 15:35; Acts 11:22-27; Gal 2:9; Acts 13:9
- v2 — Gal 1:15; Acts 9:15; 1 Cor 12:11; Rom 1:1; 2 Tim 1:11
- v3 — Acts 6:6; 2 Tim 2:2; Acts 13:2; Acts 14:26; Acts 14:23
- v10 — John 8:44; 2 Cor 11:3; Matt 13:38; Gal 1:7; Hos 14:9
- v22 — 1 Sam 13:13-14; 1 Kgs 15:5; Ps 78:70-72; 1 Sam 16:13; 1 Sam 16:1
- v33 — Ps 2:7; Heb 5:5; Heb 1:5-6
- v38 — Luke 24:47; 2 Cor 5:18-21; 1 John 2:12; Acts 5:31; Col 1:14
- v39 — Rom 10:4; Gal 2:16; Rom 8:3; Heb 7:19; Rom 10:10
- v41 — Hab 1:5; 1 Pet 4:17; Rom 11:7-14; Col 1:26-27; Isa 28:14-22
- v46 — Acts 28:28; Matt 21:43; Acts 26:20; Acts 18:5-6; Rom 2:10
- v47 — Isa 49:6; Isa 42:6; Luke 2:32; Isa 45:22; Zech 8:20-23
- v48 — Rom 8:29-30; Eph 1:4; Rom 11:7; John 10:26-27; John 10:16

Chapter 14

Paul and Barnabas preached in Iconium, fled to Lystra and Derbe, and at Lystra Paul healed a man crippled from birth. The crowd tried to worship them as gods, but Jews from Antioch and Iconium stirred up the people, stoned Paul, and left him for dead. He rose up, and they

returned through the cities strengthening the disciples.

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| 1 <i>And it came to pass in Iconium, that they went both together into the synagogue of the Jews, and so spake, that a great multitude both of the Jews and also of the Greeks believed.</i> | At Iconium Paul and Barnabas went as usual into the Jewish synagogue. They spoke so effectively that a great number of Jews and Greeks believed. |
| 2 <i>But the unbelieving Jews stirred up the Gentiles, and made their minds evil affected against the brethren.</i> | But the Jews who refused to believe stirred up the other Gentiles and poisoned their minds against the brothers. |
| 3 <i>Long time therefore abode they speaking boldly in the Lord, which gave testimony unto the word of his grace, and granted signs and wonders to be done by their hands.</i> | So Paul and Barnabas spent considerable time there, speaking boldly for the Lord, who confirmed the message of His grace by enabling them to perform signs and wonders. |
| 4 <i>But the multitude of the city was divided: and part held with the Jews, and part with the apostles.</i> | The people of the city were divided; some sided with the Jews, others with the apostles. |
| 5 <i>And when there was an assault made both of the Gentiles, and also of the Jews with their rulers, to use them despitefully, and to stone them,</i> | There was a plot afoot among both Gentiles and Jews, together with their leaders, to mistreat them and stone them. |
| 6 <i>They were ware of it, and fled unto Lystra and Derbe, cities of Lycaonia, and unto the region that lieth round about:</i> | But they found out about it and fled to the Lycaonian cities of Lystra and Derbe and to the surrounding country, |
| 7 <i>And there they preached the gospel.</i> | where they continued to preach the gospel. |
| 8 <i>And there sat a certain man at Lystra, impotent in his feet, being a cripple from his mother's womb, who never had walked:</i> | In Lystra there sat a man who was lame. He had been lame from birth and had never walked. |

- 9 *The same heard Paul speak: who stedfastly beholding him, and perceiving that he had faith to be healed,* He listened to Paul as he was speaking. Paul looked directly at him, saw that he had faith to be healed
- 10 *Said with a loud voice, Stand upright on thy feet. And he leaped and walked.* and called out, "Stand up on your feet!" At that, the man jumped up and began to walk.
- 11 *And when the people saw what Paul had done, they lifted up their voices, saying in the speech of Lycaonia, The gods are come down to us in the likeness of men.* When the crowd saw what Paul had done, they shouted in the Lycaonian language, "The gods have come down to us in human form!"
- 12 *And they called Barnabas, Jupiter; and Paul, Mercurius, because he was the chief speaker.* Barnabas they called Jupiter, and Paul they called Mercurius because he was the chief speaker.
- 13 *Then the priest of Jupiter, which was before their city, brought oxen and garlands unto the gates, and would have done sacrifice with the people.* The priest of Jupiter, whose temple was just outside the city, brought bulls and wreaths to the city gates because he and the crowd wanted to offer sacrifices to them.
- 14 *Which when the apostles, Barnabas and Paul, heard of, they rent their clothes, and ran in among the people, crying out,* But when the apostles Barnabas and Paul heard of this, they tore their clothes and rushed out into the crowd, shouting:
- 15 *And saying, Sirs, why do ye these things? We also are men of like passions with you, and preach unto you that ye should turn from these vanities unto the living God, which made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all things that are therein:* "Friends, why are you doing this? We too are only human, like you. We are bringing you good news, telling you to turn from these worthless things to the living God, Who made the heavens and the earth and the sea and everything in them."
- 16 *Who in times past suffered all nations to walk in their own ways.* "In the past, He let all nations go their own way."

- 17 *Nevertheless he left not himself without witness, in that he did good, and gave us rain from heaven, and fruitful seasons, filling our hearts with food and gladness.* "Yet He has not left Himself without testimony: He has shown kindness by giving you rain from heaven and crops in their seasons; He provides you with plenty of food and fills your hearts with joy."
- 18 *And with these sayings scarce restrained they the people, that they had not done sacrifice unto them.* Even with these words, they had difficulty keeping the crowd from sacrificing to them.
- 19 *And there came thither certain Jews from Antioch and Iconium, who persuaded the people, and, having stoned Paul, drew him out of the city, supposing he had been dead.* Then some Jews came from Antioch and Iconium and won the crowd over. They stoned Paul and dragged him outside the city, thinking he was dead.
- 20 *Howbeit, as the disciples stood round about him, he rose up, and came into the city: and the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe.* But after the disciples had gathered around him, he got up and went back into the city. The next day he and Barnabas left for Derbe.
- 21 *And when they had preached the gospel to that city, and had taught many, they returned again to Lystra, and to Iconium, and Antioch,* They preached the gospel in that city and won a large number of disciples. Then they returned to Lystra, Iconium, and Antioch,
- 22 *Confirming the souls of the disciples, and exhorting them to continue in the faith, and that we must through much tribulation enter into the kingdom of God.* strengthening the disciples and encouraging them to remain true to the faith. "We must go through many hardships to enter the kingdom of God," they said.
- 23 *And when they had ordained them elders in every church, and had prayed with fasting, they commended them to the Lord, on whom they believed.* Paul and Barnabas appointed elders for them in each church and, with prayer and fasting, committed them to the Lord, in whom they had put their trust.
- 24 *And after they had passed throughout Pisidia, they came to Pamphylia.* After going through Pisidia, they came into Pamphylia.

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| 25 | <i>And when they had preached the word in Perga, they went down into Attalia:</i> | When they had preached the word in Perga, they went down to Attalia. |
| 26 | <i>And thence sailed to Antioch, from whence they had been recommended to the grace of God for the work which they fulfilled.</i> | From Attalia they sailed back to Antioch, where they had been committed to the grace of God for the work they had now completed. |
| 27 | <i>And when they were come, and had gathered the church together, they rehearsed all that God had done with them, and how he had opened the door of faith unto the Gentiles.</i> | On arriving there, they gathered the church together and reported all that God had done through them and how He had opened a door of faith to the Gentiles. |
| 28 | <i>And there they abode long time with the disciples.</i> | They stayed there a long time with the disciples. |
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Words in this chapter:

faith — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Acts 18:4; Acts 13:51; Acts 13:46
- v2** — Acts 13:50; Acts 14:19; Acts 17:5; Acts 21:27-30; Acts 13:45
- v3** — Heb 2:4; Eph 6:18-20; Acts 20:32; Acts 20:24; Mark 16:20
- v8** — Acts 3:2
- v11** — Acts 28:6; Acts 8:10
- v15** — Acts 10:26; 1 Cor 8:4; Ps 146:5-6; Jas 5:17; 1 Sam 12:21
- v16** — Acts 17:30; Ps 81:12; Rom 1:28; Ps 147:20
- v17** — Rom 1:19-20; Joel 2:23; Job 5:10; Deut 11:14; Isa 5:6
- v19** — 2 Cor 11:25; 2 Tim 3:11; Acts 13:50-51; Acts 14:5; Acts 13:45
- v22** — 1 Pet 5:10; 2 Tim 3:12; John 16:33; Rom 8:17; 1 Thess 3:2-4
- v23** — Titus 1:5; Jas 5:14; Acts 11:30; 2 Tim 2:2; Acts 20:32
- v27** — 1 Cor 16:9; Acts 15:12; 2 Cor 2:12; Col 4:3; 1 Cor 5:4

Chapter 15

Men from Judaea insisted that Gentile believers must be circumcised to be saved, so Paul and Barnabas went to Jerusalem for the apostles and elders to settle the matter. James declared that Gentiles should not be burdened with the law beyond a few necessary things, and the council sent a letter confirming this decision. Paul and Barnabas parted ways over John Mark, with Barnabas sailing to Cyprus and Paul choosing Silas for his second journey.

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| 1 <i>And certain men which came down from Judaea taught the brethren, and said, Except ye be circumcised after the manner of Moses, ye cannot be saved.</i> | Some men came down from Judaea and began teaching the brothers. They said, "Unless you are circumcised according to the custom of Moses, you cannot be saved." |
| 2 <i>When therefore Paul and Barnabas had no small dissension and disputation with them, they determined that Paul and Barnabas, and certain other of them, should go up to Jerusalem unto the apostles and elders about this question.</i> | Paul and Barnabas strongly disagreed and debated with these men. It was decided that Paul and Barnabas, along with some others, should go up to Jerusalem to the apostles and elders about this question. |
| 3 <i>And being brought on their way by the church, they passed through Phenice and Samaria, declaring the conversion of the Gentiles: and they caused great joy unto all the brethren.</i> | Sent on their way by the church, they passed through Phenice and Samaria. They reported the conversion of the Gentiles, and this brought great joy to all the brothers. |
| 4 <i>And when they were come to Jerusalem, they were received of the church, and of the apostles and elders, and they declared all things that God had done with them.</i> | When they arrived in Jerusalem, they were welcomed by the church and the apostles and elders. They reported everything God had done through them. |
| 5 <i>But there rose up certain of the sect of the Pharisees which believed, saying, That it was needful to circumcise them, and to command them to keep the law of Moses.</i> | But some believers who belonged to the sect of the Pharisees stood up and said, "The Gentiles must be circumcised and commanded to keep the law of Moses." |
| 6 <i>And the apostles and elders came together for to consider of this matter.</i> | The apostles and elders gathered together to consider this matter. |

- 7 *And when there had been much disputing, Peter rose up, and said unto them, Men and brethren, ye know how that a good while ago God made choice among us, that the Gentiles by my mouth should hear the word of the gospel, and believe.* After much debate, Peter stood up and said to them, "Brothers, you know that a long time ago God chose among us that through my mouth the Gentiles would hear the word of the gospel and believe.
- 8 *And God, which knoweth the hearts, bare them witness, giving them the Holy Ghost, even as he did unto us;* God, Who knows the heart, confirmed this by giving them the Holy Ghost, just as He did to us.
- 9 *And put no difference between us and them, purifying their hearts by faith.* He made no distinction between us and them, purifying their hearts by faith.
- 10 *Now therefore why tempt ye God, to put a yoke upon the neck of the disciples, which neither our fathers nor we were able to bear?* So why do You put God to the test by placing on the disciples a burden that neither our fathers nor we have been able to bear?
- 11 *But we believe that through the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ we shall be saved, even as they.* We believe that through the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ we are saved, just as they are."
- 12 *Then all the multitude kept silence, and gave audience to Barnabas and Paul, declaring what miracles and wonders God had wrought among the Gentiles by them.* The whole crowd became silent and listened to Barnabas and Paul as they described the miracles and wonders God had done among the Gentiles through them.
- 13 *And after they had held their peace, James answered, saying, Men and brethren, hearken unto me:* When they finished speaking, James said, "Brothers, listen to me.
- 14 *Simeon hath declared how God at the first did visit the Gentiles, to take out of them a people for his name.* Simeon has described how God first visited the Gentiles to take from them a people for His name.
- 15 *And to this agree the words of the prophets; as it is written,* This agrees with the words of the prophets, as it is written:

- 16 *After this I will return, and will build again the tabernacle of David, which is fallen down; and I will build again the ruins thereof, and I will set it up:* 'After this I will return and rebuild the tabernacle of David, which has fallen. I will rebuild its ruins and restore it,
- 17 *That the residue of men might seek after the Lord, and all the Gentiles, upon whom my name is called, saith the Lord, who doeth all these things.* so that the rest of mankind may seek the Lord — all the Gentiles on whom My name is called,' says the Lord, who does all these things.
- 18 *Known unto God are all his works from the beginning of the world.* God has known all His works from the beginning of the world.
- 19 *Wherefore my sentence is, that we trouble not them, which from among the Gentiles are turned to God:* Therefore my judgment is that we should not make it difficult for the Gentiles who are turning to God.
- 20 *But that we write unto them, that they abstain from pollutions of idols, and from fornication, and from things strangled, and from blood.* Instead we should write to them to abstain from things polluted by idols, from sexual immorality, from things that are strangled, and from blood.
- 21 *For Moses of old time hath in every city them that preach him, being read in the synagogues every sabbath day.* For from ancient generations Moses has had those who proclaim him in every city. He is read in the synagogues every Sabbath day."
- 22 *Then pleased it the apostles and elders, with the whole church, to send chosen men of their own company to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas; namely, Judas surnamed Barsabas, and Silas, chief men among the brethren:* Then the apostles and elders, with the whole church, decided to send chosen men from among them to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas — Judas called Barsabas, and Silas, leading men among the brothers.
- 23 *And they wrote letters by them after this manner; The apostles and elders and brethren send greeting unto the brethren which are of the Gentiles in Antioch and Syria and Cilicia:* They wrote a letter by their hand which said: "The apostles and elders and brothers, to the brothers of the Gentiles in Antioch and Syria and Cilicia: Greetings.

- 24 *Forasmuch as we have heard, that certain which went out from us have troubled you with words, subverting your souls, saying, Ye must be circumcised, and keep the law: to whom we gave no such commandment:* Since we have heard that some who went out from us have troubled you with words and unsettled your souls — saying you must be circumcised and keep the law — we gave them no such instruction.
- 25 *It seemed good unto us, being assembled with one accord, to send chosen men unto you with our beloved Barnabas and Paul,* So it seemed good to us, being assembled with one accord, to send chosen men to you along with our beloved Barnabas and Paul,
- 26 *Men that have hazarded their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.* men who have risked their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 27 *We have sent therefore Judas and Silas, who shall also tell you the same things by mouth.* We have therefore sent Judas and Silas, who will also report the same things to you by word of mouth.
- 28 *For it seemed good to the Holy Ghost, and to us, to lay upon you no greater burden than these necessary things;* It seemed good to the Holy Ghost and to us to place no greater burden on You than these necessary things:
- 29 *That ye abstain from meats offered to idols, and from blood, and from things strangled, and from fornication: from which if ye keep yourselves, ye shall do well. Fare ye well.* Abstain from things sacrificed to idols, from blood, from things strangled, and from sexual immorality. If You keep yourselves from these, You will do well. Farewell."
- 30 *So when they were dismissed, they came to Antioch: and when they had gathered the multitude together, they delivered the epistle:* When the men were sent off, they went to Antioch. Gathering the congregation together, they delivered the letter.
- 31 *Which when they had read, they rejoiced for the consolation.* When the people read it, they rejoiced at the encouragement it gave.
- 32 *And Judas and Silas, being prophets also themselves, exhorted the brethren with many words, and confirmed them.* Judas and Silas, who were also prophets, encouraged the brothers with many words and strengthened them.

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| 33 <i>And after they had tarried there a space, they were let go in peace from the brethren unto the apostles.</i> | After they had stayed there for some time, the brothers sent them off in peace to the apostles. |
| 34 <i>Notwithstanding it pleased Silas to abide there still.</i> | But Silas chose to remain there. |
| 35 <i>Paul also and Barnabas continued in Antioch, teaching and preaching the word of the Lord, with many others also.</i> | Paul and Barnabas also stayed in Antioch, teaching and preaching the word of the Lord, along with many others. |
| 36 <i>And some days after Paul said unto Barnabas, Let us go again and visit our brethren in every city where we have preached the word of the Lord, and see how they do.</i> | Some days later Paul said to Barnabas, "Let us go back and visit the brothers in every city where we preached the word of the Lord, and see how they are doing." |
| 37 <i>And Barnabas determined to take with them John, whose surname was Mark.</i> | Barnabas wanted to take with them John, who was called Mark. |
| 38 <i>But Paul thought not good to take him with them, who departed from them from Pamphylia, and went not with them to the work.</i> | Paul did not think it wise to take him, since he had left them in Pamphylia and had not gone with them to the work. |
| 39 <i>And the contention was so sharp between them, that they departed asunder one from the other: and so Barnabas took Mark, and sailed unto Cyprus;</i> | There was such a sharp disagreement between them that they parted ways. Barnabas took Mark and sailed to Cyprus. |
| 40 <i>And Paul chose Silas, and departed, being recommended by the brethren unto the grace of God.</i> | Paul chose Silas and left, commended by the brothers to the grace of God. |
| 41 <i>And he went through Syria and Cilicia, confirming the churches.</i> | He traveled through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the churches. |

Words in this chapter:

Pharisees (FAIR-ih-seez) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Silas (*SY-las*) — Paul's missionary companion on the second journey — a prophet and Roman citizen who was jailed with Paul in Philippi and prayed and sang with him at midnight.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gal 5:6; Acts 15:5; Col 2:8; Lev 12:3; Gal 2:11-14
- v7 — Rom 10:17-18; Gal 2:7-9; 1 Chr 28:4-5
- v9 — Eph 3:6; Rom 3:22; Gal 5:6; Acts 10:28
- v10 — Gal 5:1; Matt 23:4; Gal 4:9; Heb 9:9
- v11 — Rom 3:24; Titus 3:4-7; Eph 2:5-9; Titus 2:11; Gal 2:16
- v16 — Amos 9:11-12; Luke 1:31-33; Ps 89:35-49; Ezek 17:22-24
- v17 — Zech 2:11; Zech 8:20-23; Isa 65:1; Hos 2:23; Isa 66:18-21
- v18 — Eph 3:9; Eph 1:4; Isa 46:9-10; Eph 1:11; 1 Pet 1:20
- v20 — Acts 15:29; Rev 2:20; Rev 2:14; Gen 9:4; Lev 3:17
- v24 — Gal 5:12; Gal 5:10; Acts 15:1; Gal 1:7; Titus 1:10-11
- v29 — Acts 15:20; Acts 21:25; Rev 2:14; Rev 2:20; Lev 17:14
- v36 — Acts 14:6; Acts 13:4; Acts 14:24-25; Acts 13:13-14; Acts 13:51

Chapter 16

Paul chose Timothy as a companion, and the Spirit directed them to Macedonia where Lydia believed and was baptized at Philippi. Paul cast a spirit of divination out of a slave girl, was beaten and imprisoned with Silas, and at midnight an earthquake opened the prison doors. The jailer and his household believed and were baptized that night.

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| 1 <i>Then came he to Derbe and Lystra:
and, behold, a certain disciple was
there, named Timotheus, the son of a
certain woman, which was a Jewess,
and believed; but his father was a
Greek:</i> | Paul came to Derbe and then to Lystra.
A disciple was there named
Timotheus, the son of a Jewish woman
who believed, but his father was a
Greek. |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Timotheus** (tih-MOH-thee-us) — Timothy; Paul's young companion and co-worker, who became one of his closest associates in ministry.

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| 2 <i>Which was well reported of by the
brethren that were at Lystra and
Iconium.</i> | He was spoken well of by the brothers
at Lystra and Iconium. |
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| 3 | <i>Him would Paul have to go forth with him; and took and circumcised him because of the Jews which were in those quarters: for they knew all that his father was a Greek.</i> | Paul wanted Timothy to travel with him. He took him and circumcised him because of the Jews in that region, for they all knew that his father was a Greek. |
| 4 | <i>And as they went through the cities, they delivered them the decrees for to keep, that were ordained of the apostles and elders which were at Jerusalem.</i> | As they traveled through the cities, they delivered to the believers the decisions that had been handed down by the apostles and elders in Jerusalem. |
| 5 | <i>And so were the churches established in the faith, and increased in number daily.</i> | So the churches were strengthened in the faith and grew in number every day. |
| 6 | <i>Now when they had gone throughout Phrygia and the region of Galatia, and were forbidden of the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia,</i> | They traveled through Phrygia and the region of Galatia, having been kept by the Holy Ghost from preaching the word in Asia. |
| 7 | <i>After they were come to Mysia, they assayed to go into Bithynia: but the Spirit suffered them not.</i> | When they came to Mysia, they tried to enter Bithynia, but the Spirit did not allow them. |
| 8 | <i>And they passing by Mysia came down to Troas.</i> | Passing by Mysia, they went down to Troas. |
| 9 | <i>And a vision appeared to Paul in the night; There stood a man of Macedonia, and prayed him, saying, Come over into Macedonia, and help us.</i> | A vision appeared to Paul during the night — a man of Macedonia was standing and appealing to him, saying, "Come over to Macedonia and help us." |
| 10 | <i>And after he had seen the vision, immediately we endeavoured to go into Macedonia, assuredly gathering that the Lord had called us for to preach the gospel unto them.</i> | After Paul had seen the vision, we immediately sought to go to Macedonia, concluding that God had called us to preach the gospel to them. |

- 11 *Therefore loosing from Troas, we came with a straight course to Samothracia, and the next day to Neapolis;* Setting sail from Troas, we went straight to Samothracia, and the next day to Neapolis.
- 12 *And from thence to Philippi, which is the chief city of that part of Macedonia, and a colony: and we were in that city abiding certain days.* From there we went to Philippi, which is a leading city of that part of Macedonia and a Roman colony. We stayed in that city for some days.
- 13 *And on the sabbath we went out of the city by a river side, where prayer was wont to be made; and we sat down, and spake unto the women which resorted thither.* On the Sabbath we went outside the city gate to a riverside, where we supposed there was a place of prayer. We sat down and spoke to the women who had gathered there.
- 14 *And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, which worshipped God, heard us: whose heart the Lord opened, that she attended unto the things which were spoken of Paul.* A woman named Lydia, a seller of purple cloth from the city of Thyatira, who worshipped God, was listening. The Lord opened her heart to pay attention to what Paul was saying.
- **NAME NOTE** — **Lydia** (LID-ee-ah) — A businesswoman from Thyatira who sold purple cloth; the first recorded convert in Europe, and a generous host to Paul's team.
- 15 *And when she was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying, If ye have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house, and abide there. And she constrained us.* When she and her household were baptized, she urged us, "If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and stay." She persuaded us to come.
- 16 *And it came to pass, as we went to prayer, a certain damsel possessed with a spirit of divination met us, which brought her masters much gain by soothsaying:* As we were going to the place of prayer, a slave girl met us who had a spirit of divination. She brought her masters great profit by fortune-telling.

- 17 *The same followed Paul and us, and cried, saying, These men are the servants of the most high God, which shew unto us the way of salvation.* She followed Paul and the rest of us and cried out, "These men are servants of the Most High God, Who are telling You the way of salvation."
- 18 *And this did she many days. But Paul, being grieved, turned and said to the spirit, I command thee in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her. And he came out the same hour.* She kept doing this for many days. Paul became greatly troubled. He turned and said to the spirit, "I command You in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her." It came out that very hour.
- 19 *And when her masters saw that the hope of their gains was gone, they caught Paul and Silas, and drew them into the marketplace unto the rulers,* When her masters saw that their hope of profit was gone, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them into the marketplace before the authorities.
- 20 *And brought them to the magistrates, saying, These men, being Jews, do exceedingly trouble our city,* They brought them before the magistrates, saying, "These men are Jews and are greatly disturbing our city.
- 21 *And teach customs, which are not lawful for us to receive, neither to observe, being Romans.* They are teaching customs that are not lawful for us to accept or practice, since we are Romans."
- 22 *And the multitude rose up together against them: and the magistrates rent off their clothes, and commanded to beat them.* The crowd joined in the attack against them. The magistrates tore the clothes off Paul and Silas and ordered them to be beaten with rods.
- 23 *And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the jailor to keep them safely:* After inflicting many blows on them, they threw them into prison, ordering the jailer to keep them securely.
- 24 *Who, having received such a charge, thrust them into the inner prison, and made their feet fast in the stocks.* Receiving this order, he put them in the inner prison and fastened their feet in the stocks.

- 25 *And at midnight Paul and Silas prayed, and sang praises unto God: and the prisoners heard them.* Around midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the other prisoners were listening to them.
- 26 *And suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken: and immediately all the doors were opened, and every one's bands were loosed.* Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken. All the doors immediately flew open, and everyone's chains were loosened.
- 27 *And the keeper of the prison awaking out of his sleep, and seeing the prison doors open, he drew out his sword, and would have killed himself, supposing that the prisoners had been fled.* The jailer woke up and saw the prison doors standing open. He drew his sword and was about to kill himself, thinking the prisoners had escaped.
- 28 *But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, Do thyself no harm: for we are all here.* But Paul called out loudly, "Do not harm yourself — we are all here!"
- 29 *Then he called for a light, and sprang in, and came trembling, and fell down before Paul and Silas,* The jailer called for lights and rushed in. Trembling, he fell down before Paul and Silas.
- 30 *And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved?* He brought them outside and said, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"
- 31 *And they said, Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.* They said, "Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and You will be saved — you and Your household."
- 32 *And they spake unto him the word of the Lord, and to all that were in his house.* They spoke the word of the Lord to Him and to all who were in His house.
- 33 *And he took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes; and was baptized, he and all his, straightway.* He took them that same hour of the night and washed their wounds. He and His entire household were baptized right away.

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| <p>34 <i>And when he had brought them into his house, he set meat before them, and rejoiced, believing in God with all his house.</i></p> <p>35 <i>And when it was day, the magistrates sent the serjeants, saying, Let those men go.</i></p> <p>36 <i>And the keeper of the prison told this saying to Paul, The magistrates have sent to let you go: now therefore depart, and go in peace.</i></p> <p>37 <i>But Paul said unto them, They have beaten us openly uncondemned, being Romans, and have cast us into prison; and now do they thrust us out privily? nay verily; but let them come themselves and fetch us out.</i></p> <p>38 <i>And the serjeants told these words unto the magistrates: and they feared, when they heard that they were Romans.</i></p> <p>39 <i>And they came and besought them, and brought them out, and desired them to depart out of the city.</i></p> <p>40 <i>And they went out of the prison, and entered into the house of Lydia: and when they had seen the brethren, they comforted them, and departed.</i></p> | <p>He brought them into His house and set food before them. He rejoiced greatly, having believed in God with His entire household.</p> <p>When day came, the magistrates sent officers with the order, "Release those men."</p> <p>The jailer reported these words to Paul: "The magistrates have sent word to release you. Go now and leave in peace."</p> <p>But Paul said to the officers, "They beat us publicly without a trial — and we are Roman citizens! They threw us into prison, and now they want to send us away secretly? No. Let them come themselves and lead us out."</p> <p>The officers reported this to the magistrates. When they heard that Paul and Silas were Roman citizens, they were alarmed.</p> <p>They came and apologized to them. They led them out and asked them to leave the city.</p> <p>Paul and Silas left the prison and went to Lydia's house. They saw the brothers, encouraged them, and then departed.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Tim 1:5; 1 Cor 4:17; Acts 17:14; Acts 18:5; 1 Tim 1:2
v3 — Gal 2:3; 1 Cor 9:20; Gal 5:6; Gal 5:1-3
v5 — Acts 9:31; Acts 2:47; Acts 6:7
v8 — 2 Tim 4:13; 2 Cor 2:12; Acts 16:11; Acts 20:5
v14 — Luke 24:45; Eph 1:17-18; Isa 50:5; John 6:44-45; Rev 3:20
v15 — Acts 11:14; Heb 13:2; Acts 16:33; Gen 19:3; Luke 24:29
v16 — Lev 19:31; Deut 18:9-11; Isa 8:19; 1 Sam 28:7; 1 Chr 10:13
v17 — John 14:6; 1 Pet 2:16; Mark 5:7; Dan 6:20; Dan 3:26
v18 — Mark 16:17; Luke 10:17-19; Mark 9:25-26; Acts 3:6; Acts 19:12-17
v25 — 1 Thess 5:16-18; Ps 119:62; Jas 1:2; Rom 5:3; 1 Pet 1:6-8
v26 — Acts 4:31; Acts 5:19; Acts 12:10; Acts 12:7; Ps 146:7
v31 — John 3:36; John 1:12; Acts 2:38-39; Rom 10:9-10; Acts 11:13-14

Chapter 17

Paul preached in Thessalonica where some Jews and many Greeks believed, but the unbelieving Jews stirred up a mob. The brethren sent Paul and Silas to Berea where the people searched the scriptures daily, and Paul went on to Athens where he preached on Mars' hill, declaring the unknown God and the resurrection of Christ.

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| 1 | <i>Now when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where was a synagogue of the Jews:</i> | Passing through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where there was a synagogue of the Jews. |
| 2 | <i>And Paul, as his manner was, went in unto them, and three sabbath days reasoned with them out of the scriptures,</i> | As was his custom, Paul went in to them and for three Sabbaths he reasoned with them from the Scriptures, |
| 3 | <i>Opening and alleging, that Christ must needs have suffered, and risen again from the dead; and that this Jesus, whom I preach unto you, is Christ.</i> | explaining and proving that the Christ had to suffer and rise from the dead. "This Jesus, whom I am proclaiming to You, is the Christ," He said. |
| 4 | <i>And some of them believed, and consorted with Paul and Silas; and of the devout Greeks a great multitude, and of the chief women not a few.</i> | Some of them were persuaded and joined Paul and Silas, along with a great number of devout Greeks and a good many leading women. |

- 5 *But the Jews which believed not, moved with envy, took unto them certain lewd fellows of the baser sort, and gathered a company, and set all the city on an uproar, and assaulted the house of Jason, and sought to bring them out to the people.* But the unbelieving Jews were filled with jealousy. They recruited some wicked men from the marketplace, gathered a mob, and threw the city into an uproar. They attacked the house of Jason, looking for Paul and Silas to bring them before the crowd.
- 6 *And when they found them not, they drew Jason and certain brethren unto the rulers of the city, crying, These that have turned the world upside down are come hither also;* When they could not find them, they dragged Jason and some of the brothers before the city rulers, shouting, "These men who have turned the world upside down have come here too!
- 7 *Whom Jason hath received: and these all do contrary to the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king, one Jesus.* Jason has welcomed them. They all act against the decrees of Caesar, saying there is another king — Jesus."
- 8 *And they troubled the people and the rulers of the city, when they heard these things.* These things stirred up the crowd and the city rulers who heard them.
- 9 *And when they had taken security of Jason, and of the other, they let them go.* They made Jason and the others post bond, and then released them.
- 10 *And the brethren immediately sent away Paul and Silas by night unto Berea: who coming thither went into the synagogue of the Jews.* The brothers immediately sent Paul and Silas away by night to Berea. When they arrived, they went into the synagogue of the Jews.
- 11 *These were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so.* The people of Berea were more honorable than those in Thessalonica. They received the word with great eagerness and searched the Scriptures every day to see if these things were true.

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| 12 <i>Therefore many of them believed; also of honourable women which were Greeks, and of men, not a few.</i> | Many of them believed, as did a good number of prominent Greek women and men. |
| 13 <i>But when the Jews of Thessalonica had knowledge that the word of God was preached of Paul at Berea, they came thither also, and stirred up the people.</i> | When the Jews of Thessalonica learned that Paul was proclaiming the word of God at Berea, they came there too and stirred up the crowds. |
| 14 <i>And then immediately the brethren sent away Paul to go as it were to the sea: but Silas and Timotheus abode there still.</i> | The brothers immediately sent Paul away to the coast, while Silas and Timothy remained behind. |
| 15 <i>And they that conducted Paul brought him unto Athens: and receiving a commandment unto Silas and Timotheus for to come to him with all speed, they departed.</i> | Those escorting Paul brought him as far as Athens. They left with instructions for Silas and Timothy to come to him as soon as possible. |
| 16 <i>Now while Paul waited for them at Athens, his spirit was stirred in him, when he saw the city wholly given to idolatry.</i> | While Paul was waiting for them in Athens, he was deeply troubled to see how full of idols the city was. |
| 17 <i>Therefore disputed he in the synagogue with the Jews, and with the devout persons, and in the market daily with them that met with him.</i> | So he reasoned in the synagogue with the Jews and with the devout people, and in the marketplace every day with those he met. |
| 18 <i>Then certain philosophers of the Epicureans, and of the Stoicks, encountered him. And some said, What will this babbler say? other some, He seemeth to be a setter forth of strange gods: because he preached unto them Jesus, and the resurrection.</i> | Some of the Epicurean and Stoic philosophers also debated with Him. Some said, "What is this chatterbox trying to say?" Others said, "He seems to be proclaiming foreign gods" — because He was preaching Jesus and the resurrection. |

- 19 *And they took him, and brought him unto Areopagus, saying, May we know what this new doctrine, whereof thou speakest, is?* They took hold of Him and brought Him to the Areopagus. They said, "May we know what this new teaching is that You are presenting?
- 20 *For thou bringest certain strange things to our ears: we would know therefore what these things mean.* Some of the things You say sound strange to us. We want to know what they mean."
- 21 *(For all the Athenians and strangers which were there spent their time in nothing else, but either to tell, or to hear some new thing.)* Now all the Athenians and the foreigners who lived there spent their time doing nothing but talking about and listening to the latest ideas.
- 22 *Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars' hill, and said, Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious.* Paul stood in the middle of Mars' hill and said, "Men of Athens, I see that in every way you are too superstitious.
- 23 *For as I passed by, and beheld your devotions, I found an altar with this inscription, TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. Whom therefore ye ignorantly worship, him declare I unto you.* As I walked around and looked carefully at the things You worship, I even found an altar with this inscription: TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. It is this very God — whom You worship without knowing — that I am declaring to You.
- 24 *God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that he is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands;* God, Who made the world and everything in it, is Lord of heaven and earth. He does not live in temples made by human hands.
- 25 *Neither is worshipped with men's hands, as though he needed any thing, seeing he giveth to all life, and breath, and all things;* He is not served by human hands as though He needed anything, since He Himself gives life and breath and everything to everyone.
- 26 *And hath made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation;* From one blood He made every nation of mankind to live on all the face of the earth. He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands.

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| <p>27 <i>That they should seek the Lord, if haply they might feel after him, and find him, though he be not far from every one of us:</i></p> <p>28 <i>For in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Forasmuch then as we are the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Godhead is like unto gold, or silver, or stone, graven by art and man's device.</i></p> | <p>He did this so that people would seek God and perhaps reach out for Him and find Him — though He is not far from each one of us.</p> <p>For in Him we live and move and have our being. As some of Your own poets have said, 'We are His offspring.'</p> <p>Since we are God's offspring, we should not think that the Godhead is like gold or silver or stone — shaped by human skill and imagination.</p> |
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- **WORD NOTE** — **Godhead** (GOD-hed) — the divine nature of God; the Trinity considered as one being. When Paul says the Godhead cannot be made of gold or stone, he means God in His full divine nature is beyond anything crafted by human hands.
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| <p>30 <i>And the times of this ignorance God winked at; but now commandeth all men every where to repent:</i></p> <p>31 <i>Because he hath appointed a day, in the which he will judge the world in righteousness by that man whom he hath ordained; whereof he hath given assurance unto all men, in that he hath raised him from the dead.</i></p> <p>32 <i>And when they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked: and others said, We will hear thee again of this matter.</i></p> <p>33 <i>So Paul departed from among them.</i></p> | <p>In the past God overlooked such times of ignorance. But now He commands all people everywhere to repent.</p> <p>He has set a day on which He will judge the world in righteousness by the Man he has appointed. He has given proof of this to everyone by raising Him from the dead."</p> <p>When they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked. Others said, "We will hear you again about this."</p> <p>So Paul left from among them.</p> |
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- 34 *Howbeit certain men clave unto him, and believed: among the which was Dionysius the Areopagite, and a woman named Damaris, and others with them.* But some men joined him and believed. Among them were Dionysius the Areopagite, a woman named Damaris, and others with them.

Words in this chapter:

godhead — The divine nature of God — the Trinity considered as one being; God in His full divine essence.

Athens (*ATH-enz*) — The intellectual capital of ancient Greece — Paul preached on the Areopagus (Mars Hill) here, engaging with Greek philosophers about the 'unknown god.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Thess 1:1; Phil 4:16; Acts 20:4; 2 Thess 1:1; 2 Tim 4:10
v6 — Acts 24:5; Acts 16:19-21; Acts 28:22; Luke 23:5; Acts 21:28-31
v11 — Isa 34:16; Prov 2:1-5; John 5:39; 1 Thess 2:13; 1 Pet 1:10-12
v23 — Gal 4:8-9; John 4:22; John 17:3; John 17:25; 1 Cor 1:21
v24 — 1 Kgs 8:27; Deut 10:14; Acts 7:48; Isa 66:1; 2 Chr 6:18
v25 — Ps 50:8-13; Gen 2:7; Isa 42:5; Rom 11:35; Acts 17:28
v26 — Deut 32:7-8; Gen 3:20; Mal 2:10; Rom 5:12-19; 1 Cor 15:22
v27 — Jer 23:23-24; Deut 4:7; Acts 14:17; Rom 1:20; Acts 15:17
v28 — Job 12:10; Col 1:17; Heb 1:3; Ps 36:9; Luke 20:38
v29 — Isa 40:25; Ex 20:4; Isa 46:5-6; Ps 115:4-8; Hab 2:19-20
v30 — Acts 14:16; Titus 2:11-12; Luke 24:47; Rom 3:25; 1 Pet 4:3
v31 — Rom 2:16; Matt 25:31-46; 2 Pet 3:7; Ps 98:9; Ps 9:8

Chapter 18

Paul came to Corinth, lived with Aquila and Priscilla, and worked as a tentmaker while preaching in the synagogue every sabbath. The Lord told Paul in a vision not to be afraid, and he stayed a year and six months teaching the word. Apollos, an eloquent Alexandrian Jew, began preaching in Ephesus and was instructed more perfectly by Aquila and Priscilla.

- 1 *After these things Paul departed from Athens, and came to Corinth;* After these things Paul left Athens and came to Corinth.

- 2 *And found a certain Jew named Aquila, born in Pontus, lately come from Italy, with his wife Priscilla; (because that Claudius had commanded all Jews to depart from Rome;) and came unto them.* There he found a Jew named Aquila, a native of Pontus, who had recently come from Italy with his wife Priscilla, because Claudius had ordered all Jews to leave Rome. Paul went to visit them.
- 3 *And because he was of the same craft, he abode with them, and wrought: for by their occupation they were tentmakers.* Since he was of the same trade, he stayed with them and they worked together — for they were tentmakers by trade.
- 4 *And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews and the Greeks.* He reasoned in the synagogue every Sabbath and persuaded both Jews and Greeks.
- 5 *And when Silas and Timotheus were come from Macedonia, Paul was pressed in the spirit, and testified to the Jews that Jesus was Christ.* When Silas and Timothy arrived from Macedonia, Paul devoted himself entirely to the word. He testified to the Jews that Jesus was the Christ.
- 6 *And when they opposed themselves, and blasphemed, he shook his raiment, and said unto them, Your blood be upon your own heads; I am clean: from henceforth I will go unto the Gentiles.* When they resisted and insulted Him, He shook out His clothes and said to them, "Your blood is on Your own heads. I am innocent. From now on I will go to the Gentiles."
- 7 *And he departed thence, and entered into a certain man's house, named Justus, one that worshipped God, whose house joined hard to the synagogue.* He left from there and went to the house of a man named Justus, a worshipper of God, whose house was next door to the synagogue.
- 8 *And Crispus, the chief ruler of the synagogue, believed on the Lord with all his house; and many of the Corinthians hearing believed, and were baptized.* Crispus, the ruler of the synagogue, believed in the Lord together with His entire household. Many of the Corinthians who heard also believed and were baptized.

- 9 *Then spake the Lord to Paul in the night by a vision, Be not afraid, but speak, and hold not thy peace:* The Lord spoke to Paul one night in a vision: "Do not be afraid. Keep speaking — do not be silent.
- 10 *For I am with thee, and no man shall set on thee to hurt thee: for I have much people in this city.* For I am with you, and no one will lay a hand on you to harm you. I have many people in this city."
- 11 *And he continued there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.* Paul stayed there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.
- 12 *And when Gallio was the deputy of Achaia, the Jews made insurrection with one accord against Paul, and brought him to the judgment seat,* When Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews made a united attack on Paul and brought him before the judgment seat.
- 13 *Saying, This fellow persuadeth men to worship God contrary to the law.* They said, "This man is persuading people to worship God in ways contrary to the law."
- 14 *And when Paul was now about to open his mouth, Gallio said unto the Jews, If it were a matter of wrong or wicked lewdness, O ye Jews, reason would that I should bear with you:* Just as Paul was about to speak, Gallio said to the Jews, "If this were a matter of wrongdoing or serious crime, I would have reason to hear your complaint.
- 15 *But if it be a question of words and names, and of your law, look ye to it; for I will be no judge of such matters.* But since it is a question about words and names and your own law, see to it yourselves. I am not willing to be a judge of such matters."
- 16 *And he drave them from the judgment seat.* He drove them away from the judgment seat.
- 17 *Then all the Greeks took Sosthenes, the chief ruler of the synagogue, and beat him before the judgment seat. And Gallio cared for none of those things.* Then all the Greeks seized Sosthenes, the ruler of the synagogue, and beat him in front of the judgment seat. But Gallio paid no attention to any of it.

- 18 *And Paul after this tarried there yet a good while, and then took his leave of the brethren, and sailed thence into Syria, and with him Priscilla and Aquila; having shorn his head in Cenchrea: for he had a vow.* Paul stayed on for many more days. Then he said farewell to the brothers and sailed for Syria, with Priscilla and Aquila. He had his head shaved at Cenchrea because he had made a vow.
- 19 *And he came to Ephesus, and left them there: but he himself entered into the synagogue, and reasoned with the Jews.* They came to Ephesus, where he left Priscilla and Aquila. He himself went into the synagogue and reasoned with the Jews.
- 20 *When they desired him to tarry longer time with them, he consented not;* When they asked him to stay longer, he declined.
- 21 *But bade them farewell, saying, I must by all means keep this feast that cometh in Jerusalem: but I will return again unto you, if God will. And he sailed from Ephesus.* He said farewell to them, saying, "I must by all means keep this coming feast in Jerusalem, but I will return to you again if God wills." Then He sailed from Ephesus.
- 22 *And when he had landed at Caesarea, and gone up, and saluted the church, he went down to Antioch.* When he landed at Caesarea, he went up and greeted the church, then went down to Antioch.
- 23 *And after he had spent some time there, he departed, and went over all the country of Galatia and Phrygia in order, strengthening all the disciples.* After spending some time there, he left and traveled through the region of Galatia and Phrygia, strengthening all the disciples.
- 24 *And a certain Jew named Apollos, born at Alexandria, an eloquent man, and mighty in the scriptures, came to Ephesus.* A Jew named Apollos, a native of Alexandria, came to Ephesus. He was an eloquent man, well-versed in the Scriptures.
- 25 *This man was instructed in the way of the Lord; and being fervent in the spirit, he spake and taught diligently the things of the Lord, knowing only the baptism of John.* He had been taught the way of the Lord. He spoke with great enthusiasm and taught accurately the things about Jesus, though He knew only the baptism of John.

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| <p>26 <i>And he began to speak boldly in the synagogue: whom when Aquila and Priscilla had heard, they took him unto them, and expounded unto him the way of God more perfectly.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And when he was disposed to pass into Achaia, the brethren wrote, exhorting the disciples to receive him: who, when he was come, helped them much which had believed through grace:</i></p> <p>28 <i>For he mightily convinced the Jews, and that publickly, shewing by the scriptures that Jesus was Christ.</i></p> | <p>He began to speak boldly in the synagogue. When Priscilla and Aquila heard him, they took him aside and explained to Him the way of God more accurately.</p> <p>When Apollos wanted to cross to Achaia, the brothers encouraged Him and wrote to the disciples to welcome Him. When He arrived, He greatly helped those who through grace had believed.</p> <p>He powerfully refuted the Jews in public, demonstrating through the Scriptures that Jesus was the Christ.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Apollos (*ah-POL-os*) — A learned Jewish Christian from Alexandria — eloquent in the Scriptures and mighty in argument; Priscilla and Aquila taught him a more accurate understanding of the faith.

Aquila (*AK-wih-lah*) — A Jewish tent-maker from Pontus who worked and traveled with Paul — expelled from Rome by Emperor Claudius; husband of Priscilla; his name means 'eagle.'

Priscilla (*prih-SIL-ah*) — Wife of Aquila, a tent-maker couple who hosted a church in their home — worked with Paul and taught Apollos; her name is a Latin diminutive of Prisca ('ancient').

Corinth (*KOR-inth*) — A major commercial city in southern Greece — Paul founded a church here on his second journey; the city's notorious immorality shaped many of Paul's letters.

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Cor 1:2; 2 Tim 4:20; Acts 19:1; 2 Cor 1:1

v2 — Rom 16:3-4; 1 Cor 16:19; 2 Tim 4:19; Acts 11:28; Acts 18:26

v3 — 1 Cor 4:12; 1 Thess 2:9; 2 Cor 11:7; 2 Thess 3:8-9; 2 Cor 11:9

v5 — 2 Cor 5:14; Acts 18:28; Acts 9:22; Acts 17:3; Acts 20:21
 v6 — Ezek 33:4; 2 Sam 1:16; Ezek 33:8-9; Ezek 18:13; Neh 5:13
 v8 — 1 Cor 1:13-17; Mark 16:15-16; Rom 10:14-17
 v9 — Acts 23:11; Ezek 2:6-8; Eph 6:19-20; Acts 27:23-25
 v10 — Ex 4:12; 2 Cor 12:9; Isa 41:10; Matt 28:20; Rom 8:31
 v19 — 1 Tim 1:3; 2 Tim 1:18; Eph 1:1
 v21 — 1 Cor 4:19; Jas 4:15; Acts 20:16; Heb 6:3; Rom 15:32
 v24 — 1 Cor 4:6; 1 Cor 3:5-6; Titus 3:13; 1 Cor 1:12; 1 Cor 16:12
 v28 — 1 Cor 15:3-4; Acts 18:5; Acts 9:22; Acts 26:22-23

Chapter 19

Paul arrived in Ephesus, laid hands on twelve disciples who received the Holy Ghost, and taught for two years so that all who dwelt in Asia heard the word. God worked special miracles through Paul, and the seven sons of Sceva were overpowered by an evil spirit. The silversmith Demetrius stirred up a riot because Paul's preaching threatened the worship of Diana.

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| 1 | <i>And it came to pass, that, while Apollos was at Corinth, Paul having passed through the upper coasts, came to Ephesus: and finding certain disciples,</i> | While Apollos was at Corinth, Paul traveled through the upper regions and came to Ephesus. He found some disciples there |
| 2 | <i>He said unto them, Have ye received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? And they said unto him, We have not so much as heard whether there be any Holy Ghost.</i> | and asked them, "Did You receive the Holy Ghost when You believed?" They replied, "We have not even heard that there is a Holy Ghost." |
| 3 | <i>And he said unto them, Unto what then were ye baptized? And they said, Unto John's baptism.</i> | He said, "Then what baptism did you receive?" They said, "John's baptism." |
| 4 | <i>Then said Paul, John verily baptized with the baptism of repentance, saying unto the people, that they should believe on him which should come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus.</i> | Paul said, "John baptized with a baptism of repentance. He told the people to believe in the One coming after him — that is, in Christ Jesus." |
| 5 | <i>When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.</i> | When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. |

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| 6 <i>And when Paul had laid his hands upon them, the Holy Ghost came on them; and they spake with tongues, and prophesied.</i> | When Paul laid his hands on them, the Holy Ghost came on them. They spoke with tongues and prophesied. |
| 7 <i>And all the men were about twelve.</i> | There were about twelve men in all. |
| 8 <i>And he went into the synagogue, and spake boldly for the space of three months, disputing and persuading the things concerning the kingdom of God.</i> | He went into the synagogue and spoke boldly for three months, arguing and persuading them about the kingdom of God. |
| 9 <i>But when divers were hardened, and believed not, but spake evil of that way before the multitude, he departed from them, and separated the disciples, disputing daily in the school of one Tyrannus.</i> | But when some became stubborn and refused to believe — speaking evil of the Way before the crowd — Paul left them. He took the disciples with him and reasoned daily in the school of Tyrannus. |
| 10 <i>And this continued by the space of two years; so that all they which dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks.</i> | This went on for two years, so that all who lived in Asia — both Jews and Greeks — heard the word of the Lord Jesus. |
| 11 <i>And God wrought special miracles by the hands of Paul:</i> | God did extraordinary miracles through Paul's hands. |
| 12 <i>So that from his body were brought unto the sick handkerchiefs or aprons, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out of them.</i> | Even handkerchiefs and aprons that had touched him were brought to the sick, and their diseases left them and the evil spirits came out of them. |
| 13 <i>Then certain of the vagabond Jews, exorcists, took upon them to call over them which had evil spirits the name of the Lord Jesus, saying, We adjure you by Jesus whom Paul preacheth.</i> | Some itinerant Jewish exorcists also tried invoking the name of the Lord Jesus over those who had evil spirits. They would say, "I command You by the Jesus whom Paul preaches." |
| 14 <i>And there were seven sons of one Sceva, a Jew, and chief of the priests, which did so.</i> | Seven sons of Sceva, a Jewish chief priest, were doing this. |

- 15 *And the evil spirit answered and said, Jesus I know, and Paul I know; but who are ye?* The evil spirit answered them, "Jesus I know, and Paul I know — but who are you?"
- 16 *And the man in whom the evil spirit was leaped on them, and overcame them, and prevailed against them, so that they fled out of that house naked and wounded.* The man who had the evil spirit jumped on them and overpowered all of them. He attacked with such force that they fled from the house naked and wounded.
- 17 *And this was known to all the Jews and Greeks also dwelling at Ephesus; and fear fell on them all, and the name of the Lord Jesus was magnified.* This became known to all the Jews and Greeks living in Ephesus. Fear came over all of them, and the name of the Lord Jesus was held in high honor.
- 18 *And many that believed came, and confessed, and shewed their deeds.* Many who had believed came and openly confessed what they had done.
- 19 *Many of them also which used curious arts brought their books together, and burned them before all men: and they counted the price of them, and found it fifty thousand pieces of silver.* Many who had practiced sorcery brought their scrolls together and burned them publicly. When they counted up the value, it came to fifty thousand pieces of silver.
- 20 *So mightily grew the word of God and prevailed.* In this way the word of God grew mightily and spread.
- 21 *After these things were ended, Paul purposed in the spirit, when he had passed through Macedonia and Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying, After I have been there, I must also see Rome.* After these things were completed, Paul resolved in the Spirit to travel through Macedonia and Achaia and then go to Jerusalem. He said, "After I have been there, I must also see Rome."
- 22 *So he sent into Macedonia two of them that ministered unto him, Timotheus and Erastus; but he himself stayed in Asia for a season.* He sent two of his helpers — Timothy and Erastus — to Macedonia, while he himself stayed in Asia for a while.
- 23 *And the same time there arose no small stir about that way.* About that time there arose a serious disturbance about the Way.

- 24 *For a certain man named Demetrius, a silversmith, which made silver shrines for Diana, brought no small gain unto the craftsmen;* A silversmith named Demetrius, who made silver shrines of Diana, provided a great deal of business for the craftsmen.
- 25 *Whom he called together with the workmen of like occupation, and said, Sirs, ye know that by this craft we have our wealth.* He called them together, along with the workers in similar trades, and said, "Men, you know that our prosperity comes from this business.
- 26 *Moreover ye see and hear, that not alone at Ephesus, but almost throughout all Asia, this Paul hath persuaded and turned away much people, saying that they be no gods, which are made with hands:* You see and hear that this Paul has persuaded and turned away a great many people — not only in Ephesus but almost throughout all Asia. He says that gods made by human hands are not real gods.
- 27 *So that not only this our craft is in danger to be set at nought; but also that the temple of the great goddess Diana should be despised, and her magnificence should be destroyed, whom all Asia and the world worshippeth.* Our trade is in danger of falling into disrepute. Not only that, but the temple of the great goddess Diana may be discredited and her greatness destroyed — she whom all Asia and the world worship."
- 28 *And when they heard these sayings, they were full of wrath, and cried out, saying, Great is Diana of the Ephesians.* When they heard this, they were filled with rage and began shouting, "Great is Diana of the Ephesians!"
- 29 *And the whole city was filled with confusion: and having caught Gaius and Aristarchus, men of Macedonia, Paul's companions in travel, they rushed with one accord into the theatre.* The city was filled with confusion. They seized Gaius and Aristarchus, Macedonians who were Paul's traveling companions, and rushed together into the theater.
- 30 *And when Paul would have entered in unto the people, the disciples suffered him not.* Paul wanted to go in to the crowd, but the disciples would not let him.

- 31 *And certain of the chief of Asia, which were his friends, sent unto him, desiring him that he would not adventure himself into the theatre.* Even some of the leading officials of Asia who were his friends sent word urging him not to venture into the theater.
- 32 *Some therefore cried one thing, and some another: for the assembly was confused; and the more part knew not wherefore they were come together.* Some shouted one thing and some another. The assembly was in confusion. Most of the people did not even know why they had gathered.
- 33 *And they drew Alexander out of the multitude, the Jews putting him forward. And Alexander beckoned with the hand, and would have made his defence unto the people.* Some from the crowd pulled Alexander forward, the Jews having pushed him out front. Alexander motioned with his hand and wanted to make a defense to the crowd.
- 34 *But when they knew that he was a Jew, all with one voice about the space of two hours cried out, Great is Diana of the Ephesians.* But when they recognized that he was a Jew, they all shouted together for about two hours, "Great is Diana of the Ephesians!"
- 35 *And when the townclerk had appeased the people, he said, Ye men of Ephesus, what man is there that knoweth not how that the city of the Ephesians is a worshipper of the great goddess Diana, and of the image which fell down from Jupiter?* The city clerk quieted the crowd and said, "Men of Ephesus, who does not know that the city of Ephesus is the guardian of the great goddess Diana and of the image which fell down from Jupiter?"
- 36 *Seeing then that these things cannot be spoken against, ye ought to be quiet, and to do nothing rashly.* Since these things cannot be denied, you should be calm and do nothing rash.
- 37 *For ye have brought hither these men, which are neither robbers of churches, nor yet blasphemers of your goddess.* You have brought these men here who are neither temple robbers nor blasphemers of our goddess.

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| <p>38 <i>Wherefore if Demetrius, and the craftsmen which are with him, have a matter against any man, the law is open, and there are deputies: let them implead one another.</i></p> <p>39 <i>But if ye enquire any thing concerning other matters, it shall be determined in a lawful assembly.</i></p> <p>40 <i>For we are in danger to be called in question for this day's uproar, there being no cause whereby we may give an account of this concourse.</i></p> <p>41 <i>And when he had thus spoken, he dismissed the assembly.</i></p> | <p>If Demetrius and his fellow craftsmen have a complaint against anyone, the courts are open and there are proconsuls. Let them bring charges against each other there.</p> <p>If there is any other matter you want to raise, it shall be settled in the legal assembly.</p> <p>We are in danger of being charged with rioting because of what has happened today. There is no justification we can give for this commotion."</p> <p>When he had said this, he dismissed the assembly.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

justification — Being declared not guilty by God — legally counted as righteous because of Christ's perfect record credited to the believer.

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

v2 — Gal 3:5; 1 Cor 6:19; John 7:39; Acts 11:15-17

v4 — Acts 1:5; John 1:29-34; Acts 11:16; Luke 3:16-18

v5 — Acts 8:16; Acts 8:12; 1 Cor 10:2; Acts 2:38; Rom 6:3-4

v6 — Acts 6:6; Acts 2:4; Mark 16:17

v9 — Acts 19:23; Acts 18:6-8; Acts 9:2

v11 — Acts 5:12; Mark 16:17-20; Rom 15:18-19; Heb 2:4; Acts 8:13

v12 — Acts 5:15; 2 Kgs 13:20-21; Mark 16:17; 2 Kgs 4:29-31

v13 — Matt 12:27; Mark 9:38; Luke 11:19; Acts 8:18-19

v15 — Acts 16:17-18; Mark 1:34; Mark 5:9-13; Luke 4:33-35; Mark 1:24

v20 — Acts 6:7; Acts 12:24; Isa 55:11; 2 Thess 3:1

v26 — Acts 17:29; 1 Cor 8:4; Isa 44:10-20

v29 — Acts 20:4; Col 4:10; Phlm 1:24; Acts 27:2

Chapter 20

Paul traveled through Macedonia and Greece, and at Troas he preached until midnight when the young man Eutychus fell from a window and was taken up dead, but Paul embraced him and his life came back. Paul called the Ephesian elders to Miletus and warned them that grievous wolves would enter among them, commending them to God and to the word of His grace.

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| 1 | <i>And after the uproar was ceased, Paul called unto him the disciples, and embraced them, and departed for to go into Macedonia.</i> | After the uproar ended, Paul sent for the disciples. After encouraging them, he said farewell and set out for Macedonia. |
| 2 | <i>And when he had gone over those parts, and had given them much exhortation, he came into Greece,</i> | He traveled through that region, encouraging the believers with many words. Then he came to Greece, |
| 3 | <i>And there abode three months. And when the Jews laid wait for him, as he was about to sail into Syria, he purposed to return through Macedonia.</i> | where he stayed for three months. When the Jews plotted against him just as he was about to sail to Syria, he decided to return through Macedonia. |
| 4 | <i>And there accompanied him into Asia Sopater of Berea; and of the Thessalonians, Aristarchus and Secundus; and Gaius of Derbe, and Timotheus; and of Asia, Tychicus and Trophimus.</i> | He was accompanied to Asia by Sopater of Berea, Aristarchus and Secundus of the Thessalonians, Gaius of Derbe, and Timothy, as well as Tychicus and Trophimus from Asia. |
| 5 | <i>These going before tarried for us at Troas.</i> | These men went ahead and waited for us at Troas. |
| 6 | <i>And we sailed away from Philippi after the days of unleavened bread, and came unto them to Troas in five days; where we abode seven days.</i> | We sailed from Philippi after the Feast of Unleavened Bread and joined them at Troas in five days. We stayed there for seven days. |
| 7 | <i>And upon the first day of the week, when the disciples came together to break bread, Paul preached unto them, ready to depart on the morrow; and continued his speech until midnight.</i> | On the first day of the week, the disciples gathered to break bread. Paul spoke to them since he planned to leave the next day. He continued speaking until midnight. |

- 8 *And there were many lights in the upper chamber, where they were gathered together.* There were many lamps in the upper room where we were gathered.
- 9 *And there sat in a window a certain young man named Eutychus, being fallen into a deep sleep: and as Paul was long preaching, he sunk down with sleep, and fell down from the third loft, and was taken up dead.* A young man named Eutychus was sitting in the window and sank into a deep sleep as Paul talked on and on. Overcome by sleep, he fell from the third floor and was picked up dead.
- 10 *And Paul went down, and fell on him, and embracing him said, Trouble not yourselves; for his life is in him.* Paul went down, threw himself on the young man, and embraced him. He said, "Do not be alarmed — his life is in him."
- 11 *When he therefore was come up again, and had broken bread, and eaten, and talked a long while, even till break of day, so he departed.* Paul went back upstairs, broke bread, and ate. He talked with them for a long time — until daybreak — then left.
- 12 *And they brought the young man alive, and were not a little comforted.* The people took the young man home alive and were greatly comforted.
- 13 *And we went before to ship, and sailed unto Assos, there intending to take in Paul: for so had he appointed, minding himself to go afoot.* We went ahead to the ship and sailed to Assos, where we were to take Paul on board. He had arranged this because he intended to travel there on foot.
- 14 *And when he met with us at Assos, we took him in, and came to Mitylene.* When he met us at Assos, we took him on board and went to Mitylene.
- 15 *And we sailed thence, and came the next day over against Chios; and the next day we arrived at Samos, and tarried at Trogyllium; and the next day we came to Miletus.* Sailing from there, we came the next day opposite Chios. The day after, we arrived at Samos and waited at Trogyllium. The following day we reached Miletus.

- 16 *For Paul had determined to sail by Ephesus, because he would not spend the time in Asia: for he hasted, if it were possible for him, to be at Jerusalem the day of Pentecost.* Paul had decided to sail past Ephesus so he would not have to spend time in Asia. He was hurrying to be in Jerusalem, if possible, by the day of Pentecost.
- 17 *And from Miletus he sent to Ephesus, and called the elders of the church.* From Miletus he sent word to Ephesus and called for the elders of the church.
- 18 *And when they were come to him, he said unto them, Ye know, from the first day that I came into Asia, after what manner I have been with you at all seasons,* When they came to him, he said to them, "You know how I lived among you the entire time from the first day I arrived in Asia.
- 19 *Serving the Lord with all humility of mind, and with many tears, and temptations, which befell me by the lying in wait of the Jews:* I served the Lord with great humility, with tears, and through trials that came from the plots of the Jews.
- 20 *And how I kept back nothing that was profitable unto you, but have shewed you, and have taught you publickly, and from house to house,* I did not hold back anything that was helpful to you. I taught you publicly and from house to house.
- 21 *Testifying both to the Jews, and also to the Greeks, repentance toward God, and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ.* I declared to both Jews and Greeks that they must turn to God in repentance and have faith in our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 22 *And now, behold, I go bound in the spirit unto Jerusalem, not knowing the things that shall befall me there:* Now I am going to Jerusalem, compelled by the Spirit. I do not know what will happen to me there.
- 23 *Save that the Holy Ghost witnesseth in every city, saying that bonds and afflictions abide me.* Only I know that in every city the Holy Ghost warns me that chains and hardship await me.

- 24 *But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear unto myself, so that I might finish my course with joy, and the ministry, which I have received of the Lord Jesus, to testify the gospel of the grace of God.* None of these things move me. I do not count my life of any value to myself, so long as I can finish the race and complete the ministry I received from the Lord Jesus — to testify to the gospel of the grace of God.
- 25 *And now, behold, I know that ye all, among whom I have gone preaching the kingdom of God, shall see my face no more.* Now I know that none of You among whom I have gone preaching the kingdom of God will see my face again.
- 26 *Wherefore I take you to record this day, that I am pure from the blood of all men.* Therefore I declare to You this day that I am innocent of the blood of everyone.
- 27 *For I have not shunned to declare unto you all the counsel of God.* For I did not hold back from declaring to You the whole counsel of God.
- 28 *Take heed therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock, over the which the Holy Ghost hath made you overseers, to feed the church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood.* Pay careful attention to yourselves and to all the flock over which the Holy Ghost has made You overseers. Shepherd the church of God, which He purchased with His own blood.
- 29 *For I know this, that after my departing shall grievous wolves enter in among you, not sparing the flock.* I know that after I leave, fierce wolves will come in among You and will not spare the flock.
- 30 *Also of your own selves shall men arise, speaking perverse things, to draw away disciples after them.* Even from Your own group, men will arise speaking twisted things in order to draw disciples away after them.
- 31 *Therefore watch, and remember, that by the space of three years I ceased not to warn every one night and day with tears.* So stay alert. Remember that for three years I never stopped warning each one of you night and day with tears.

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| 32 | <i>And now, brethren, I commend you to God, and to the word of his grace, which is able to build you up, and to give you an inheritance among all them which are sanctified.</i> | Now I commit You to God and to the word of His grace. He is able to build You up and give You an inheritance among all those who are sanctified. |
| 33 | <i>I have coveted no man's silver, or gold, or apparel.</i> | I have not coveted anyone's silver or gold or clothing. |
| 34 | <i>Yea, ye yourselves know, that these hands have ministered unto my necessities, and to them that were with me.</i> | You yourselves know that these hands have provided for my own needs and for those who were with me. |
| 35 | <i>I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.</i> | In all things I have shown You that by working hard like this we must help the weak. We must remember the words of the Lord Jesus: "It is more blessed to give than to receive." |
| 36 | <i>And when he had thus spoken, he kneeled down, and prayed with them all.</i> | When He had finished speaking, He knelt down and prayed with all of them. |
| 37 | <i>And they all wept sore, and fell on Paul's neck, and kissed him,</i> | They all wept greatly, fell on Paul's neck, and kissed him. |
| 38 | <i>Sorrowing most of all for the words which he spake, that they should see his face no more. And they accompanied him unto the ship.</i> | They grieved most of all over his words — that they would see his face no more. Then they walked with him to the ship. |

Words in this chapter:

Pentecost (*PEN-teh-cost*) — The Feast of Weeks — celebrated fifty days after Passover; the harvest festival; in the NT, the day the Holy Spirit came on the early church.

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

- v4** — Acts 19:29; Eph 6:21; 2 Tim 4:20; Col 4:7; 2 Tim 4:12
v7 — 1 Cor 16:2; Acts 2:42; John 20:19; John 20:1; Rev 1:10
v18 — 1 Thess 1:5-6; Acts 18:19; Acts 19:1; Acts 19:10
v19 — Col 3:24; 2 Cor 2:4; Rom 12:11; Acts 20:3; 2 Cor 4:7-11
v20 — Acts 20:27; Acts 5:42; 2 Tim 4:2; Acts 20:31; Col 1:28
v21 — Acts 2:38; Acts 11:18; 1 John 5:11-13; Luke 24:47; Acts 20:24
v23 — Acts 9:16; Acts 21:4; 1 Thess 3:3; Acts 21:33; Acts 14:22
v24 — 2 Tim 4:6-8; 2 Cor 12:10; 2 Cor 4:1; 1 Cor 15:58; Acts 21:13
v28 — 1 Pet 5:2-3; 1 Tim 4:16; 1 Pet 1:18-19; Isa 40:11; 1 Tim 3:2
v32 — Col 1:12; Eph 1:14; Col 3:24; Acts 26:18; Eph 1:18
v33 — 2 Cor 11:9; 1 Cor 9:12; 1 Cor 9:18; 2 Cor 7:2
v35 — Heb 13:16; Prov 19:17; 2 Cor 9:6-12; Luke 14:12-14; Matt 10:8

Chapter 21

Paul sailed to Jerusalem despite warnings from the brethren that bonds and afflictions awaited him. He met with James and the elders and agreed to purify himself at the temple, but Jews from Asia stirred up the crowd against him. The Roman soldiers rescued Paul from the mob and allowed him to address the people.

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| <p>1 <i>And it came to pass, that after we were gotten from them, and had launched, we came with a straight course unto Coos, and the day following unto Rhodes, and from thence unto Patara:</i></p> | <p>After we had parted from them and set sail, we went straight to Cos. The next day we went to Rhodes, and from there to Patara.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And finding a ship sailing over unto Phenicia, we went aboard, and set forth.</i></p> | <p>We found a ship crossing to Phenicia, went aboard, and set sail.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Now when we had discovered Cyprus, we left it on the left hand, and sailed into Syria, and landed at Tyre: for there the ship was to unlade her burden.</i></p> | <p>We came within sight of Cyprus, passed it on our left, and sailed on to Syria. We landed at Tyre, where the ship was to unload its cargo.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And finding disciples, we tarried there seven days: who said to Paul through the Spirit, that he should not go up to Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>We found the disciples there and stayed seven days. Through the Spirit they urged Paul not to go up to Jerusalem.</p> |

- 5 *And when we had accomplished those days, we departed and went our way; and they all brought us on our way, with wives and children, till we were out of the city: and we kneeled down on the shore, and prayed.* When our time was up, we left and continued on our way. All the disciples, with their wives and children, escorted us outside the city. We knelt down on the beach and prayed.
- 6 *And when we had taken our leave one of another, we took ship; and they returned home again.* Then we said farewell to one another, we boarded the ship, and they went back home.
- 7 *And when we had finished our course from Tyre, we came to Ptolemais, and saluted the brethren, and abode with them one day.* We completed our voyage from Tyre and arrived at Ptolemais. We greeted the brothers and stayed with them one day.
- 8 *And the next day we that were of Paul's company departed, and came unto Caesarea: and we entered into the house of Philip the evangelist, which was one of the seven; and abode with him.* The next day we left and came to Caesarea. We entered the house of Philip the evangelist, one of the seven, and stayed with him.
- 9 *And the same man had four daughters, virgins, which did prophesy.* He had four unmarried daughters who prophesied.
- 10 *And as we tarried there many days, there came down from Judaea a certain prophet, named Agabus.* While we were staying there for several days, a prophet named Agabus came down from Judaea.
- 11 *And when he was come unto us, he took Paul's girdle, and bound his own hands and feet, and said, Thus saith the Holy Ghost, So shall the Jews at Jerusalem bind the man that owneth this girdle, and shall deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles.* Coming to us, he took Paul's belt, bound his own hands and feet with it, and said, "The Holy Ghost says this: 'The Jews at Jerusalem will bind the man who owns this belt and hand him over to the Gentiles.'"
- 12 *And when we heard these things, both we, and they of that place, besought him not to go up to Jerusalem.* When we heard this, both we and the local people begged Paul not to go up to Jerusalem.

- 13 *Then Paul answered, What mean ye to weep and to break mine heart? for I am ready not to be bound only, but also to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.* Paul answered, "Why are you weeping and breaking my heart? I am ready not only to be bound but even to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus."
- 14 *And when he would not be persuaded, we ceased, saying, The will of the Lord be done.* When He could not be persuaded, we stopped urging Him and said, "The will of the Lord be done."
- 15 *And after those days we took up our carriages, and went up to Jerusalem.* After these days we packed our bags and went up to Jerusalem.
- 16 *There went with us also certain of the disciples of Caesarea, and brought with them one Mnason of Cyprus, an old disciple, with whom we should lodge.* Some of the disciples from Caesarea also went with us and brought us to the home of Mnason of Cyprus, an early disciple, with whom we were to stay.
- 17 *And when we were come to Jerusalem, the brethren received us gladly.* When we arrived in Jerusalem, the brothers welcomed us gladly.
- 18 *And the day following Paul went in with us unto James; and all the elders were present.* The next day Paul went in with us to James, and all the elders were present.
- 19 *And when he had saluted them, he declared particularly what things God had wrought among the Gentiles by his ministry.* After greeting them, Paul reported in detail what God had done among the Gentiles through His ministry.
- 20 *And when they heard it, they glorified the Lord, and said unto him, Thou seest, brother, how many thousands of Jews there are which believe; and they are all zealous of the law:* When they heard this, they praised the Lord. They said to Paul, "You see, brother, how many thousands of Jews have believed, and they are all zealous for the law."

- 21 *And they are informed of thee, that thou teachest all the Jews which are among the Gentiles to forsake Moses, saying that they ought not to circumcise their children, neither to walk after the customs.* They have been told about you that you teach all the Jews who live among the Gentiles to turn away from Moses — telling them not to circumcise their children or walk according to the customs.
- 22 *What is it therefore? the multitude must needs come together: for they will hear that thou art come.* What is to be done? They will certainly hear that you have come.
- 23 *Do therefore this that we say to thee: We have four men which have a vow on them;* Do what we tell you. We have four men who have taken a vow.
- 24 *Them take, and purify thyself with them, and be at charges with them, that they may shave their heads: and all may know that those things, whereof they were informed concerning thee, are nothing; but that thou thyself also walkest orderly, and keepest the law.* Take them and purify yourself along with them and pay their expenses so they can have their heads shaved. Then everyone will know that the reports about you are false — that you yourself also live in obedience to the law.
- 25 *As touching the Gentiles which believe, we have written and concluded that they observe no such thing, save only that they keep themselves from things offered to idols, and from blood, and from strangled, and from fornication.* As for the Gentiles who have believed, we have sent them a letter with our decision that they should abstain from things sacrificed to idols, from blood, from what is strangled, and from sexual immorality."
- 26 *Then Paul took the men, and the next day purifying himself with them entered into the temple, to signify the accomplishment of the days of purification, until that an offering should be offered for every one of them.* Then Paul took the men, and the next day he purified himself with them and went into the temple. He announced the completion of the days of purification, when an offering would be made for each of them.

- 27 *And when the seven days were almost ended, the Jews which were of Asia, when they saw him in the temple, stirred up all the people, and laid hands on him,* When the seven days were almost over, some Jews from Asia saw him in the temple. They stirred up the whole crowd and seized him,
- 28 *Crying out, Men of Israel, help: This is the man, that teacheth all men every where against the people, and the law, and this place: and further brought Greeks also into the temple, and hath polluted this holy place.* crying out, "Men of Israel, help! This is the man who teaches everyone everywhere against our people, our law, and this place! He has also brought Greeks into the temple and defiled this holy place."
- 29 *(For they had seen before with him in the city Trophimus an Ephesian, whom they supposed that Paul had brought into the temple.)* They had previously seen Trophimus the Ephesian in the city with Paul and assumed Paul had brought him into the temple.
- 30 *And all the city was moved, and the people ran together: and they took Paul, and drew him out of the temple: and forthwith the doors were shut.* The whole city was stirred up and the people came running together. They seized Paul and dragged him out of the temple, and the doors were immediately shut.
- 31 *And as they went about to kill him, tidings came unto the chief captain of the band, that all Jerusalem was in an uproar.* While they were trying to kill him, a report reached the commander of the Roman regiment that all Jerusalem was in an uproar.
- 32 *Who immediately took soldiers and centurions, and ran down unto them: and when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, they left beating of Paul.* He immediately took soldiers and centurions and ran down to the crowd. When the people saw the commander and the soldiers, they stopped beating Paul.
- 33 *Then the chief captain came near, and took him, and commanded him to be bound with two chains; and demanded who he was, and what he had done.* The commander came up, arrested Paul, and ordered him to be chained with two chains. He then asked who he was and what he had done.

- 34 *And some cried one thing, some another, among the multitude: and when he could not know the certainty for the tumult, he commanded him to be carried into the castle.* Some in the crowd shouted one thing and some another. Since the commander could not find out the facts because of the uproar, he ordered Paul to be brought into the barracks.
- 35 *And when he came upon the stairs, so it was, that he was borne of the soldiers for the violence of the people.* When Paul reached the steps, the soldiers had to carry him because of the violent pressure of the crowd.
- 36 *For the multitude of the people followed after, crying, Away with him.* The crowd followed, shouting, "Away with him!"
- 37 *And as Paul was to be led into the castle, he said unto the chief captain, May I speak unto thee? Who said, Canst thou speak Greek?* As Paul was about to be taken into the barracks, he said to the commander, "May I say something to you?" The commander replied, "Do you know Greek?"
- 38 *Art not thou that Egyptian, which before these days madest an uproar, and leddest out into the wilderness four thousand men that were murderers?* "Aren't you the Egyptian who stirred up a revolt some time ago and led four thousand assassins out into the wilderness?"
- 39 *But Paul said, I am a man which am a Jew of Tarsus, a city in Cilicia, a citizen of no mean city: and, I beseech thee, suffer me to speak unto the people.* Paul replied, "I am a Jew, a citizen of Tarsus in Cilicia — no insignificant city. Please let me speak to the people."
- 40 *And when he had given him licence, Paul stood on the stairs, and beckoned with the hand unto the people. And when there was made a great silence, he spake unto them in the Hebrew tongue, saying,* The commander gave permission, so Paul stood on the steps and motioned to the crowd with his hand. When silence fell, he spoke to them in the Hebrew language, saying,

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Acts 20:22-23; Acts 21:10-12
- v8 — Acts 6:5; Acts 8:26-40; Eph 4:11
- v13 — Acts 20:24; Phil 1:20-21; Phil 2:17; Rom 8:35-37; 2 Tim 4:6
- v19 — Acts 14:27; Acts 1:17
- v20 — Rom 10:2; Gal 1:14; Acts 22:3
- v21 — Gal 6:12-15; 1 Cor 9:19-21; Gal 5:1-6
- v24 — Acts 21:26; Acts 24:18; Acts 18:18
- v26 — Acts 24:18; Acts 21:24; Num 6:13-20
- v33 — Eph 6:20; Acts 21:11; Acts 20:23; Acts 12:6
- v34 — Acts 23:10; Acts 19:32
- v36 — John 19:15; Acts 22:22; Luke 23:18
- v39 — Acts 22:3; Acts 9:11

Chapter 22

Paul spoke to the crowd in Hebrew, telling them of his conversion on the road to Damascus and his commission to preach to the Gentiles. The crowd listened until he mentioned the Gentiles, then cried out for his death. The chief captain ordered him to be examined by scourging, but Paul revealed his Roman citizenship and was spared.

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| 1 | <i>Men, brethren, and fathers, hear ye my defence which I make now unto you.</i> | "Brothers and fathers, listen to the defense I now make before you." |
| 2 | <i>(And when they heard that he spake in the Hebrew tongue to them, they kept the more silence: and he saith,)</i> | When they heard him speak to them in the Hebrew language, they became even quieter. He said, |
| 3 | <i>I am verily a man which am a Jew, born in Tarsus, a city in Cilicia, yet brought up in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, and taught according to the perfect manner of the law of the fathers, and was zealous toward God, as ye all are this day.</i> | "I am a Jew, born in Tarsus of Cilicia, but raised in this city. I was educated at the feet of Gamaliel and trained thoroughly in the law of our fathers. I was just as zealous for God as all of you are today. |
| 4 | <i>And I persecuted this way unto the death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women.</i> | I persecuted the followers of this Way to the death, binding and delivering both men and women to prison. |

- 5 *As also the high priest doth bear me witness, and all the estate of the elders: from whom also I received letters unto the brethren, and went to Damascus, to bring them which were there bound unto Jerusalem, for to be punished.* The high priest and the whole council of elders can testify to this. I also received letters from them to the brothers in Damascus. I went there to arrest those people and bring them back to Jerusalem to be punished.
- 6 *And it came to pass, that, as I made my journey, and was come nigh unto Damascus about noon, suddenly there shone from heaven a great light round about me.* As I was traveling and approaching Damascus, around noon a very bright light from heaven suddenly flashed around me.
- 7 *And I fell unto the ground, and heard a voice saying unto me, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?* I fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to me, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting Me?'
- 8 *And I answered, Who art thou, Lord? And he said unto me, I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom thou persecutest.* I answered, 'Who are You, Lord?' He said to me, 'I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom You are persecuting.'
- 9 *And they that were with me saw indeed the light, and were afraid; but they heard not the voice of him that spake to me.* My companions saw the light, but they did not hear the voice of the One speaking to me.
- 10 *And I said, What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said unto me, Arise, and go into Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things which are appointed for thee to do.* I asked, 'What shall I do, Lord?' The Lord said to me, 'Get up and go into Damascus. There You will be told everything You are appointed to do.'
- 11 *And when I could not see for the glory of that light, being led by the hand of them that were with me, I came into Damascus.* Since I could not see because of the brightness of that light, I was led by the hand of those who were with me into Damascus.
- 12 *And one Ananias, a devout man according to the law, having a good report of all the Jews which dwelt there,* A man named Ananias, a devout man according to the law who had a good reputation among all the Jews living there,

- 13 *Came unto me, and stood, and said unto me, Brother Saul, receive thy sight. And the same hour I looked up upon him.* came to me, stood beside me, and said, 'Brother Saul, receive your sight.' That very hour I was able to see him.
- 14 *And he said, The God of our fathers hath chosen thee, that thou shouldest know his will, and see that Just One, and shouldest hear the voice of his mouth.* He said, 'The God of our fathers has appointed you to know His will and to see the Righteous One and to hear his voice.
- 15 *For thou shalt be his witness unto all men of what thou hast seen and heard.* For you will be His witness to all people of what you have seen and heard.
- 16 *And now why tarriest thou? arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins, calling on the name of the Lord.* Now, why do you wait? Get up, be baptized, and wash away your sins, calling on His name.'
- 17 *And it came to pass, that, when I was come again to Jerusalem, even while I prayed in the temple, I was in a trance;* When I had returned to Jerusalem and was praying in the temple, I fell into a trance
- 18 *And saw him saying unto me, Make haste, and get thee quickly out of Jerusalem: for they will not receive thy testimony concerning me.* and saw the Lord saying to me, 'Hurry and leave Jerusalem quickly, because they will not accept your testimony about Me.'
- 19 *And I said, Lord, they know that I imprisoned and beat in every synagogue them that believed on thee:* I said, 'Lord, they themselves know that I imprisoned and beat those who believed in You in every synagogue.
- 20 *And when the blood of thy martyr Stephen was shed, I also was standing by, and consenting unto his death, and kept the raiment of them that slew him.* And when the blood of Your martyr Stephen was shed, I myself was standing by, approving of his death, and keeping the clothes of those who were killing him.'
- 21 *And he said unto me, Depart: for I will send thee far hence unto the Gentiles.* But He said to me, 'Go, for I will send you far away to the Gentiles.'"

- 22 *And they gave him audience unto this word, and then lifted up their voices, and said, Away with such a fellow from the earth: for it is not fit that he should live.* The crowd listened to Paul until he said this. Then they raised their voices and shouted, "Away with such a man from the earth! He is not fit to live!"
- 23 *And as they cried out, and cast off their clothes, and threw dust into the air,* As they were shouting and throwing off their cloaks and hurling dust into the air,
- 24 *The chief captain commanded him to be brought into the castle, and bade that he should be examined by scourging; that he might know wherefore they cried so against him.* the commander ordered Paul to be brought into the barracks. He directed that he be examined by flogging so he could find out why they were shouting against him like this.
- 25 *And as they bound him with thongs, Paul said unto the centurion that stood by, Is it lawful for you to scourge a man that is a Roman, and uncondemned?* As they stretched him out for the flogging, Paul said to the centurion standing nearby, "Is it lawful for you to flog a Roman citizen who has not been condemned?"
- 26 *When the centurion heard that, he went and told the chief captain, saying, Take heed what thou doest: for this man is a Roman.* When the centurion heard this, he went to the commander and said, "Be careful what you do. This man is a Roman citizen."
- 27 *Then the chief captain came, and said unto him, Tell me, art thou a Roman? He said, Yea.* The commander went to Paul and asked, "Tell me — are you a Roman citizen?" Paul said, "Yes."
- 28 *And the chief captain answered, With a great sum obtained I this freedom. And Paul said, But I was free born.* The commander replied, "I paid a large sum for my citizenship." Paul said, "But I was born a citizen."
- 29 *Then straightway they departed from him which should have examined him: and the chief captain also was afraid, after he knew that he was a Roman, and because he had bound him.* Those who were about to question him withdrew at once. The commander himself was alarmed when he realized Paul was a Roman citizen and he had put him in chains.

- 30 *On the morrow, because he would have known the certainty wherefore he was accused of the Jews, he loosed him from his bands, and commanded the chief priests and all their council to appear, and brought Paul down, and set him before them.*
- The next day, wanting to find out the real reason Paul was being accused by the Jews, the commander released him and ordered the chief priests and the whole council to assemble. He brought Paul down and set him before them.

Words in this chapter:

centurion (*sen-TYUR-ee-un*) — A Roman army officer commanding approximately 100 soldiers — several centurions in the NT show unusual faith in Jesus.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Acts 7:2
v3 — Phil 3:5-6; Acts 26:5; Acts 9:11; Acts 5:34; Acts 21:20
v9 — Acts 9:7; Dan 10:7
v14 — Gal 1:12; 1 Cor 15:8; Acts 26:16; 1 Cor 9:1
v15 — Acts 4:20; Acts 23:11
v16 — Acts 2:38; Acts 2:21; Heb 10:22; Titus 3:5; 1 Cor 6:11
v19 — Acts 22:4; Matt 10:17
v20 — Acts 7:58; Acts 8:1
v21 — Acts 9:15; 1 Tim 2:7; Eph 3:6-8; Rom 15:16; Gal 2:7-8
v22 — Acts 25:24; Acts 21:36
v25 — Acts 16:37; Acts 25:16
v30 — Acts 23:28; Acts 21:33

Chapter 23

Paul stood before the council and set the Pharisees against the Sadducees by declaring his hope in the resurrection of the dead. The Lord stood by Paul that night and told him he must also bear witness at Rome. More than forty Jews conspired to kill Paul, but his nephew uncovered the plot, and the chief captain sent Paul by night under heavy guard to the governor Felix at Caesarea.

- 1 *And Paul, earnestly beholding the council, said, Men and brethren, I have lived in all good conscience before God until this day.*
- Paul looked straight at the council and said, "Brothers, I have lived before God with a completely clear conscience to this day."

- 2 *And the high priest Ananias commanded them that stood by him to smite him on the mouth.* The high priest Ananias commanded those standing near him to strike him on the mouth.
- 3 *Then said Paul unto him, God shall smite thee, thou whited wall: for sittest thou to judge me after the law, and commandest me to be smitten contrary to the law?* Paul said to him, "God will strike you, you whitewashed wall! You sit there to judge me according to the law, yet you yourself violate the law by ordering me to be struck."
- 4 *And they that stood by said, Revilest thou God's high priest?* Those standing nearby said, "Are you insulting God's high priest?"
- 5 *Then said Paul, I wist not, brethren, that he was the high priest: for it is written, Thou shalt not speak evil of the ruler of thy people.* Paul said, "Brothers, I did not know that he was the high priest. It is written, 'You shall not speak evil of a ruler of your people.'"
- 6 *But when Paul perceived that the one part were Sadducees, and the other Pharisees, he cried out in the council, Men and brethren, I am a Pharisee, the son of a Pharisee: of the hope and resurrection of the dead I am called in question.* When Paul saw that one group were Sadducees and the other Pharisees, he called out in the council, "Brothers, I am a Pharisee, the son of a Pharisee. I am on trial for my hope in the resurrection of the dead."
- 7 *And when he had so said, there arose a dissension between the Pharisees and the Sadducees: and the multitude was divided.* When he said this, a dispute broke out between the Pharisees and the Sadducees, and the assembly was divided.
- 8 *For the Sadducees say that there is no resurrection, neither angel, nor spirit: but the Pharisees confess both.* The Sadducees say there is no resurrection, and no angel or spirit, but the Pharisees acknowledge all of these.
- 9 *And there arose a great cry: and the scribes that were of the Pharisees' part arose, and strove, saying, We find no evil in this man: but if a spirit or an angel hath spoken to him, let us not fight against God.* There was a great uproar. Some of the scribes who were on the Pharisees' side stood up and argued strongly: "We find nothing wrong with this man. What if a spirit or an angel has spoken to him?"

- 10 *And when there arose a great dissension, the chief captain, fearing lest Paul should have been pulled in pieces of them, commanded the soldiers to go down, and to take him by force from among them, and to bring him into the castle.* When the argument became so violent that the commander was afraid Paul would be torn apart by them, he ordered the soldiers to go down, take him by force from among them, and bring him into the barracks.
- 11 *And the night following the Lord stood by him, and said, Be of good cheer, Paul: for as thou hast testified of me in Jerusalem, so must thou bear witness also at Rome.* The following night the Lord stood near Paul and said, "Take courage! As you have testified about Me in Jerusalem, so you must also testify in Rome."
- 12 *And when it was day, certain of the Jews banded together, and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they had killed Paul.* When day came, some Jews formed a conspiracy and bound themselves with an oath. They said they would neither eat nor drink until they had killed Paul.
- 13 *And they were more than forty which had made this conspiracy.* There were more than forty of them who made this oath.
- 14 *And they came to the chief priests and elders, and said, We have bound ourselves under a great curse, that we will eat nothing until we have slain Paul.* They went to the chief priests and elders and said, "We have bound ourselves with a solemn oath to eat nothing until we have killed Paul.
- 15 *Now therefore ye with the council signify to the chief captain that he bring him down unto you to morrow, as though ye would enquire something more perfectly concerning him: and we, or ever he come near, are ready to kill him.* Now then, together with the council, make a request to the commander to bring Paul down to you tomorrow, as if you were going to examine his case more carefully. We are ready to kill him before he gets here."
- 16 *And when Paul's sister's son heard of their lying in wait, he went and entered into the castle, and told Paul.* But the son of Paul's sister heard about this plot. He went into the barracks and told Paul.

- 17 *Then Paul called one of the centurions unto him, and said, Bring this young man unto the chief captain: for he hath a certain thing to tell him.* Paul called one of the centurions and said, "Take this young man to the commander. He has something to tell him."
- 18 *So he took him, and brought him to the chief captain, and said, Paul the prisoner called me unto him, and prayed me to bring this young man unto thee, who hath something to say unto thee.* The centurion took the young man to the commander and said, "The prisoner Paul called me to him and asked me to bring this young man to you. He has something to tell you."
- 19 *Then the chief captain took him by the hand, and went with him aside privately, and asked him, What is that thou hast to tell me?* The commander took the young man by the hand, drew him aside privately, and asked, "What is it you have to tell me?"
- 20 *And he said, The Jews have agreed to desire thee that thou wouldest bring down Paul to morrow into the council, as though they would enquire somewhat of him more perfectly.* He said, "The Jews have agreed to ask you to bring Paul down to the council tomorrow, as if they intend to inquire more carefully into his case."
- 21 *But do not thou yield unto them: for there lie in wait for him of them more than forty men, which have bound themselves with an oath, that they will neither eat nor drink till they have killed him: and now are they ready, looking for a promise from thee.* Do not agree to it. More than forty of them are lying in ambush for him. They have bound themselves with an oath not to eat or drink until they have killed him. They are ready now, waiting for your promise."
- 22 *So the chief captain then let the young man depart, and charged him, See thou tell no man that thou hast shewed these things to me.* The commander dismissed the young man with a warning: "Tell no one that you have reported this to me."

- 23 *And he called unto him two centurions, saying, Make ready two hundred soldiers to go to Caesarea, and horsemen threescore and ten, and spearmen two hundred, at the third hour of the night;* He called two of his centurions and said, "Get two hundred soldiers ready to march to Caesarea, along with seventy horsemen and two hundred spearmen, at nine tonight."
- 24 *And provide them beasts, that they may set Paul on, and bring him safe unto Felix the governor.* He also told them to provide horses for Paul to ride, so he could be brought safely to Felix the governor.
- 25 *And he wrote a letter after this manner:* He wrote a letter as follows:
- 26 *Claudius Lysias unto the most excellent governor Felix sendeth greeting.* "Claudius Lysias, to His Excellency the governor Felix: Greetings.
- 27 *This man was taken of the Jews, and should have been killed of them: then came I with an army, and rescued him, having understood that he was a Roman.* This man was seized by the Jews and was about to be killed by them. I came with my troops and rescued him, having learned that he was a Roman citizen.
- 28 *And when I would have known the cause wherefore they accused him, I brought him forth into their council:* Wanting to know what charge they were bringing against him, I brought him before their council.
- 29 *Whom I perceived to be accused of questions of their law, but to have nothing laid to his charge worthy of death or of bonds.* I found that he was accused about questions of their law, but no charge against him deserved death or imprisonment.
- 30 *And when it was told me how that the Jews laid wait for the man, I sent straightway to thee, and gave commandment to his accusers also to say before thee what they had against him. Fare thee well.* When I was informed that there was a plot against this man, I sent him to you at once. I have also told his accusers to present their case before you. Farewell."

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| <p>31 <i>Then the soldiers, as it was commanded them, took Paul, and brought him by night to Antipatris.</i></p> <p>32 <i>On the morrow they left the horsemen to go with him, and returned to the castle:</i></p> <p>33 <i>Who, when they came to Caesarea, and delivered the epistle to the governor, presented Paul also before him.</i></p> <p>34 <i>And when the governor had read the letter, he asked of what province he was. And when he understood that he was of Cilicia;</i></p> <p>35 <i>I will hear thee, said he, when thine accusers are also come. And he commanded him to be kept in Herod's judgment hall.</i></p> | <p>The soldiers, carrying out their orders, took Paul that night and brought him to Antipatris.</p> <p>The next day they let the horsemen continue on with him, and they returned to the barracks.</p> <p>When the horsemen arrived in Caesarea, they delivered the letter to the governor and presented Paul to him.</p> <p>When the governor had read the letter, he asked what province Paul was from. Learning that he was from Cilicia, he said, "I will hear your case when your accusers arrive." He ordered that Paul be kept under guard in Herod's palace.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Pharisees (*FAIR-ih-seez*) — The most influential Jewish religious party in the NT — strict observers of the Law and its oral traditions; many became opponents of Jesus; their name means 'separated ones.'

Sadducees (*SAD-yoo-seez*) — A Jewish priestly party that controlled the temple — they rejected the resurrection, angels, and oral tradition; they opposed both Jesus and the apostles.

Rome (*ROME*) — Capital of the Roman Empire — Paul wrote his letter to the Romans to the church there; he was eventually imprisoned and martyred in Rome.

Cross-References:

v1 — Acts 24:16; 2 Cor 1:12; 2 Tim 1:3; Heb 13:18; 1 Cor 4:4

v2 — John 18:22; Acts 24:1

v3 — Deut 25:1-2; John 7:51

v5 — Ex 22:28; Eccl 10:20; Jude 1:8-9; 2 Pet 2:10

v6 — Acts 24:15; Acts 24:21; Acts 26:5-8

v8 — Luke 20:27; Matt 22:23

v9 — Acts 22:17-18; Acts 22:7

v11 — Acts 18:9; 2 Tim 4:17; Matt 14:27; Acts 19:21; Jer 15:19-21

v12 — Acts 23:30; Isa 8:9-10; Acts 23:21; Acts 23:14; Ps 2:1-3

v24 — Acts 24:10; Acts 25:14; Acts 23:26

v29 — Acts 26:31; Acts 18:15; Acts 25:25

v35 — Acts 23:30; Acts 25:16

Chapter 24

The high priest Ananias and the orator Tertullus brought charges against Paul before Governor Felix, accusing him of being a ringleader of sedition. Paul defended himself, declaring his faith in the resurrection and his clear conscience before God. Felix heard him often over two years but left him in prison, hoping for a bribe.

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| <p>1 <i>And after five days Ananias the high priest descended with the elders, and with a certain orator named Tertullus, who informed the governor against Paul.</i></p> | <p>Five days later the high priest Ananias came down with some of the elders and a lawyer named Tertullus, and they brought charges against Paul before the governor.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And when he was called forth, Tertullus began to accuse him, saying, Seeing that by thee we enjoy great quietness, and that very worthy deeds are done unto this nation by thy providence,</i></p> | <p>When Paul was summoned, Tertullus began the prosecution: "Since through you we enjoy great peace, and since reforms are being made for this nation through your foresight,</p> |
| <p>3 <i>We accept it always, and in all places, most noble Felix, with all thankfulness.</i></p> | <p>we acknowledge this in every way and everywhere, most excellent Felix, with all gratitude.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Notwithstanding, that I be not further tedious unto thee, I pray thee that thou wouldest hear us of thy clemency a few words.</i></p> | <p>But not to take up too much of your time, I beg you in your kindness to hear us briefly.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For we have found this man a pestilent fellow, and a mover of sedition among all the Jews throughout the world, and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes:</i></p> | <p>We have found this man to be a troublemaker, stirring up riots among the Jews all over the world. He is a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes.</p> |

- 6 *Who also hath gone about to profane the temple: whom we took, and would have judged according to our law.* He even tried to desecrate the temple, so we seized him.
- 7 *But the chief captain Lysias came upon us, and with great violence took him away out of our hands,* But the commander Lysias came and took him away from us by force,
- 8 *Commanding his accusers to come unto thee: by examining of whom thyself mayest take knowledge of all these things, whereof we accuse him.* commanding his accusers to come before you. By questioning him yourself, you will be able to learn the truth about all these charges we bring against him."
- 9 *And the Jews also assented, saying that these things were so.* The Jews also joined in the accusation, asserting that these things were true.
- 10 *Then Paul, after that the governor had beckoned unto him to speak, answered, Forasmuch as I know that thou hast been of many years a judge unto this nation, I do the more cheerfully answer for myself:* When the governor motioned for Paul to speak, Paul replied, "Knowing that you have been a judge over this nation for many years, I am glad to make my defense.
- 11 *Because that thou mayest understand, that there are yet but twelve days since I went up to Jerusalem for to worship.* You can verify that it is no more than twelve days since I went up to Jerusalem to worship.
- 12 *And they neither found me in the temple disputing with any man, neither raising up the people, neither in the synagogues, nor in the city:* My accusers did not find me arguing with anyone or stirring up a crowd — not in the temple, not in the synagogues, not anywhere in the city.
- 13 *Neither can they prove the things whereof they now accuse me.* They cannot prove to you the charges they are now making against me.
- 14 *But this I confess unto thee, that after the way which they call heresy, so worship I the God of my fathers, believing all things which are written in the law and in the prophets:* However, I do admit this to you: I worship the God of our fathers according to the Way, which they call a sect. I believe everything written in the Law and in the Prophets.

- 15 *And have hope toward God, which they themselves also allow, that there shall be a resurrection of the dead, both of the just and unjust.* I have the same hope in God that these men themselves hold — that there will be a resurrection of both the righteous and the wicked.
- 16 *And herein do I exercise myself, to have always a conscience void of offence toward God, and toward men.* Because of this I always try to keep my conscience clear before God and before men.
- 17 *Now after many years I came to bring alms to my nation, and offerings.* After many years away, I came to Jerusalem to bring gifts for the poor to my nation and to present offerings.
- 18 *Whereupon certain Jews from Asia found me purified in the temple, neither with multitude, nor with tumult.* Some Jews from Asia found me doing this in the temple — I had been purified and there was no crowd, no riot.
- 19 *Who ought to have been here before thee, and object, if they had ought against me.* They are the ones who should be here before you to bring charges, if they have anything against me.
- 20 *Or else let these same here say, if they have found any evil doing in me, while I stood before the council,* Or let these men here state what wrongdoing they found when I stood before the council —
- 21 *Except it be for this one voice, that I cried standing among them, Touching the resurrection of the dead I am called in question by you this day.* unless it was for this one thing I called out while standing among them: 'It is concerning the resurrection of the dead that I am on trial before you today.'
- 22 *And when Felix heard these things, having more perfect knowledge of that way, he deferred them, and said, When Lysias the chief captain shall come down, I will know the uttermost of your cause.* Felix, who had a fairly accurate understanding of the Way, adjourned the hearing. He said, "When the commander Lysias comes down, I will decide your case."

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| 23 | <i>And he commanded a centurion to keep Paul, and to let him have liberty, and that he should forbid none of his acquaintance to minister or come unto him.</i> | He ordered the centurion to keep Paul under guard but to give him some freedom and to allow his friends to take care of his needs. |
| 24 | <i>And after certain days, when Felix came with his wife Drusilla, which was a Jewess, he sent for Paul, and heard him concerning the faith in Christ.</i> | Some days later Felix came with his wife Drusilla, who was Jewish. He sent for Paul and heard him speak about faith in Christ Jesus. |
| 25 | <i>And as he reasoned of righteousness, temperance, and judgment to come, Felix trembled, and answered, Go thy way for this time; when I have a convenient season, I will call for thee.</i> | As Paul talked about righteousness, self-control, and the coming judgment, Felix grew frightened and said, "That's enough for now. When I find a convenient time, I will send for you." |
| 26 | <i>He hoped also that money should have been given him of Paul, that he might loose him: wherefore he sent for him the oftener, and communed with him.</i> | At the same time, he was hoping that Paul would offer him a bribe, so he sent for him frequently and talked with him. |
| 27 | <i>But after two years Porcius Festus came into Felix' room: and Felix, willing to shew the Jews a favour, left Paul bound.</i> | After two years, Porcius Festus succeeded Felix. Wanting to do the Jews a favor, Felix left Paul in prison. |

Words in this chapter:

Festus (*FES-tus*) — The Roman governor who heard Paul's case after Felix — he found no Roman charge against Paul but offered to send him to Jerusalem; Paul appealed to Caesar.

Cross-References:

v5 — Acts 28:22; Acts 24:14

v12 — Acts 25:8

v13 — Acts 25:7

v14 — Acts 9:2; Rom 3:21; Acts 28:23; Acts 3:13

v15 — Dan 12:2; John 5:28-29; 1 Thess 4:14-16; Job 19:25-26; Rev 20:12-13

v16 — 1 Tim 1:5; Acts 23:1; 2 Cor 4:2; Heb 10:22; Rom 2:15

v17 — Gal 2:10; 1 Cor 16:1-4; Rom 15:25-28

v19 — Acts 23:30

v21 — Acts 23:6

v23 — Acts 28:16; Acts 27:3

v25 — John 16:8; 1 Pet 3:15; Gal 5:23; Acts 10:42; 2 Pet 1:6

v27 — Acts 25:9; Acts 25:14; Acts 12:3; Acts 25:1; Mark 15:15

Chapter 25

Festus succeeded Felix as governor, and the Jews pressed their case against Paul. When Festus proposed sending him back to Jerusalem, Paul appealed to Caesar. King Agrippa and Bernice arrived at Caesarea, and Festus presented Paul's case to them, having found no charge worthy of death.

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| <p>1 <i>Now when Festus was come into the province, after three days he ascended from Caesarea to Jerusalem.</i></p> | <p>Three days after arriving in the province, Festus went up from Caesarea to Jerusalem.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Then the high priest and the chief of the Jews informed him against Paul, and besought him,</i></p> | <p>The chief priests and leading men of the Jews presented their case against Paul to Festus and urged him</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And desired favour against him, that he would send for him to Jerusalem, laying wait in the way to kill him.</i></p> | <p>to grant them a favor by having Paul transferred to Jerusalem — for they were planning to ambush and kill him along the way.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>But Festus answered, that Paul should be kept at Caesarea, and that he himself would depart shortly thither.</i></p> | <p>Festus answered that Paul was being held at Caesarea and that he himself would be going there soon.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Let them therefore, said he, which among you are able, go down with me, and accuse this man, if there be any wickedness in him.</i></p> | <p>"Let those among you who are able come down with me," he said, "and if this man has done anything wrong, they can press charges against him there."</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And when he had tarried among them more than ten days, he went down unto Caesarea; and the next day sitting in the judgment seat commanded Paul to be brought.</i></p> | <p>After staying with them more than ten days, Festus went down to Caesarea. The next day he took his seat on the judgment bench and ordered Paul to be brought in.</p> |

- 7 *And when he was come, the Jews which came down from Jerusalem stood round about, and laid many and grievous complaints against Paul, which they could not prove.* When Paul appeared, the Jews who had come down from Jerusalem stood around him. They brought many serious charges against him that they could not prove.
- 8 *While he answered for himself, Neither against the law of the Jews, neither against the temple, nor yet against Caesar, have I offended any thing at all.* Paul said in his defense, "I have committed no offense against the Jewish law, against the temple, or against Caesar."
- 9 *But Festus, willing to do the Jews a pleasure, answered Paul, and said, Wilt thou go up to Jerusalem, and there be judged of these things before me?* Festus, wanting to do the Jews a favor, asked Paul, "Are you willing to go up to Jerusalem and be tried before me there on these charges?"
- 10 *Then said Paul, I stand at Caesar's judgment seat, where I ought to be judged: to the Jews have I done no wrong, as thou very well knowest.* Paul replied, "I am standing before Caesar's court, where I should be tried. I have done no wrong to the Jews, as you yourself know very well.
- 11 *For if I be an offender, or have committed any thing worthy of death, I refuse not to die: but if there be none of these things whereof these accuse me, no man may deliver me unto them. I appeal unto Caesar.* If I am guilty and have done something worthy of death, I do not refuse to die. But if the charges these men are bringing against me are false, no one has the right to hand me over to them. I appeal to Caesar!"
- 12 *Then Festus, when he had conferred with the council, answered, Hast thou appealed unto Caesar? unto Caesar shalt thou go.* Festus conferred with his council and then replied, "You have appealed to Caesar. To Caesar you will go."
- 13 *And after certain days king Agrippa and Bernice came unto Caesarea to salute Festus.* Some days later King Agrippa and Bernice arrived in Caesarea to pay their respects to Festus.

- 14 *And when they had been there many days, Festus declared Paul's cause unto the king, saying, There is a certain man left in bonds by Felix:* Since they spent several days there, Festus laid Paul's case before the king. He said, "There is a man here left as a prisoner by Felix.
- 15 *About whom, when I was at Jerusalem, the chief priests and the elders of the Jews informed me, desiring to have judgment against him.* When I was in Jerusalem, the chief priests and elders of the Jews brought charges against him and asked for a verdict against him.
- 16 *To whom I answered, It is not the manner of the Romans to deliver any man to die, before that he which is accused have the accusers face to face, and have licence to answer for himself concerning the crime laid against him.* I told them that it is not the Roman custom to hand over any man to be condemned before he has faced his accusers and had a chance to defend himself against the charges.
- 17 *Therefore, when they were come hither, without any delay on the morrow I sat on the judgment seat, and commanded the man to be brought forth.* When they came here, I did not delay. The very next day I sat on the judgment bench and ordered the man to be brought in.
- 18 *Against whom when the accusers stood up, they brought none accusation of such things as I supposed:* When his accusers stood up, they did not charge him with any of the crimes I had expected.
- 19 *But had certain questions against him of their own superstition, and of one Jesus, which was dead, whom Paul affirmed to be alive.* Instead they had some disputes with Him about their own religion and about a man named Jesus Who had died, whom Paul claimed was alive.
- 20 *And because I doubted of such manner of questions, I asked him whether he would go to Jerusalem, and there be judged of these matters.* Since I was unsure how to investigate such questions, I asked whether He would be willing to go to Jerusalem to stand trial on these matters.

- 21 *But when Paul had appealed to be reserved unto the hearing of Augustus, I commanded him to be kept till I might send him to Caesar.* But when Paul appealed to be held over for the Emperor's decision, I ordered him held until I could send him to Caesar."
- 22 *Then Agrippa said unto Festus, I would also hear the man myself. To morrow, said he, thou shalt hear him.* Agrippa said to Festus, "I would like to hear this man myself." "Tomorrow," said Festus, "you will hear him."
- 23 *And on the morrow, when Agrippa was come, and Bernice, with great pomp, and was entered into the place of hearing, with the chief captains, and principal men of the city, Festus' commandment Paul was brought forth.* The next day Agrippa and Bernice came with great ceremony and entered the audience hall along with the military commanders and leading men of the city. At Festus's command, Paul was brought in.
- 24 *And Festus said, King Agrippa, and all men which are here present with us, ye see this man, about whom all the multitude of the Jews have dealt with me, both at Jerusalem, and also here, crying that he ought not to live any longer.* Festus said, "King Agrippa and all who are present with us, you see this man. The whole Jewish community has petitioned me about him — both in Jerusalem and here — shouting that he should not be allowed to live any longer.
- 25 *But when I found that he had committed nothing worthy of death, and that he himself hath appealed to Augustus, I have determined to send him.* I found that he had done nothing deserving death. But since he himself has appealed to the Emperor, I decided to send him.
- 26 *Of whom I have no certain thing to write unto my lord. Wherefore I have brought him forth before you, and specially before thee, O king Agrippa, that, after examination had, I might have somewhat to write.* I have nothing definite to write to His Majesty about him. Therefore I have brought him before all of you, and especially before you, King Agrippa, so that after this examination I may have something to write.
- 27 *For it seemeth to me unreasonable to send a prisoner, and not withal to signify the crimes laid against him.* It seems absurd to me to send a prisoner without specifying the charges against him."

Words in this chapter:

Agrippa (*ah-GRIP-ah*) — King Herod Agrippa II before whom Paul made his defense in Acts 26 — he told Paul 'you almost persuade me to be a Christian.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Acts 25:15
- v6 — Acts 25:10; Acts 25:17
- v7 — Acts 24:13
- v8 — Acts 24:12; Acts 28:17
- v9 — Acts 24:27
- v11 — Acts 28:19; Acts 26:32
- v14 — Acts 24:27
- v16 — John 7:51; Deut 19:17-18
- v19 — Acts 23:29; Acts 18:15
- v24 — Acts 25:7; Acts 22:22
- v25 — Acts 23:29

Chapter 26

Paul made his defense before King Agrippa, recounting his former life as a Pharisee, his conversion on the road to Damascus, and his commission to preach to both Jews and Gentiles. Agrippa said, "Almost thou persuadest me to be a Christian," and both Agrippa and Festus agreed that Paul had done nothing worthy of death or bonds.

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| <p>1 <i>Then Agrippa said unto Paul, Thou art permitted to speak for thyself. Then Paul stretched forth the hand, and answered for himself:</i></p> | <p>Agrippa said to Paul, "You have permission to speak for yourself." Paul stretched out his hand and began his defense:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>I think myself happy, king Agrippa, because I shall answer for myself this day before thee touching all the things whereof I am accused of the Jews:</i></p> | <p>"I consider myself fortunate, King Agrippa, to be able to defend myself before you today against all the accusations of the Jews.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Epecially because I know thee to be expert in all customs and questions which are among the Jews: wherefore I beseech thee to hear me patiently.</i></p> | <p>I am especially glad because you are an expert in all the Jewish customs and controversies. I beg you to listen to me patiently.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>My manner of life from my youth, which was at the first among mine own nation at Jerusalem, know all the Jews;</i></p> | <p>All the Jews know the way I lived from my youth — first among my own people and then in Jerusalem.</p> |

- 5 *Which knew me from the beginning, if they would testify, that after the most straitest sect of our religion I lived a Pharisee.* They have known me for a long time. If they are willing to testify, they can say that I lived as a Pharisee — the strictest sect of our religion.
- 6 *And now I stand and am judged for the hope of the promise made of God unto our fathers:* Now I stand on trial because of my hope in what God promised our fathers.
- 7 *Unto which promise our twelve tribes, instantly serving God day and night, hope to come. For which hope's sake, king Agrippa, I am accused of the Jews.* This is the promise our twelve tribes hope to receive as they earnestly serve God day and night. King Agrippa, it is because of this hope that the Jews are accusing me.
- 8 *Why should it be thought a thing incredible with you, that God should raise the dead?* Why should any of you think it incredible that God raises the dead?
- 9 *I verily thought with myself, that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth.* I myself once thought I should do everything possible to oppose the name of Jesus of Nazareth.
- 10 *Which thing I also did in Jerusalem: and many of the saints did I shut up in prison, having received authority from the chief priests; and when they were put to death, I gave my voice against them.* And I did so in Jerusalem. I shut up many of the saints in prison, having received authority from the chief priests. When they were put to death, I cast my vote against them.
- 11 *And I punished them oft in every synagogue, and compelled them to blaspheme; and being exceedingly mad against them, I persecuted them even unto strange cities.* Many times I went through every synagogue and punished them. I tried to force them to blaspheme. My rage against them was so great that I even hunted them down in foreign cities.
- 12 *Whereupon as I went to Damascus with authority and commission from the chief priests,* On one of these journeys I was going to Damascus with the authority and commission of the chief priests.

- 13 *At midday, O king, I saw in the way a light from heaven, above the brightness of the sun, shining round about me and them which journeyed with me.* About noon, O king, I saw a light from heaven — brighter than the sun — blazing around me and those traveling with me.
- 14 *And when we were all fallen to the earth, I heard a voice speaking unto me, and saying in the Hebrew tongue, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.* We all fell to the ground. I heard a voice saying to me in the Hebrew language, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting Me? It is hard for you to kick against the goads.'
- 15 *And I said, Who art thou, Lord? And he said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest.* I asked, 'Who are You, Lord?' The Lord replied, 'I am Jesus, whom You are persecuting.'
- 16 *But rise, and stand upon thy feet: for I have appeared unto thee for this purpose, to make thee a minister and a witness both of these things which thou hast seen, and of those things in the which I will appear unto thee;* Now get up and stand on Your feet. I have appeared to You for this purpose — to appoint You as a servant and a witness of what You have seen and what I will show You.
- 17 *Delivering thee from the people, and from the Gentiles, unto whom now I send thee,* I will rescue You from Your own people and from the Gentiles. I am sending You to them
- 18 *To open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto God, that they may receive forgiveness of sins, and inheritance among them which are sanctified by faith that is in me.* to open their eyes so they may turn from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God. Then they will receive forgiveness of sins and a place among those who are sanctified by faith in Me.'
- 19 *Whereupon, O king Agrippa, I was not disobedient unto the heavenly vision:* So, King Agrippa, I was not disobedient to the heavenly vision.

- 20 *But shewed first unto them of Damascus, and at Jerusalem, and throughout all the coasts of Judaea, and then to the Gentiles, that they should repent and turn to God, and do works meet for repentance.* First to those in Damascus, then in Jerusalem, throughout all the region of Judaea, and then to the Gentiles, I declared that they should repent and turn to God and show their repentance by their deeds.
- 21 *For these causes the Jews caught me in the temple, and went about to kill me.* Because of this the Jews seized me in the temple and tried to kill me.
- 22 *Having therefore obtained help of God, I continue unto this day, witnessing both to small and great, saying none other things than those which the prophets and Moses did say should come:* To this day I have had God's help, so I stand here and testify to small and great alike. I say nothing beyond what the prophets and Moses said would happen —
- 23 *That Christ should suffer, and that he should be the first that should rise from the dead, and should shew light unto the people, and to the Gentiles.* that the Christ would suffer, and that He would be the first to rise from the dead, and would bring light to our own people and to the Gentiles."
- 24 *And as he thus spake for himself, Festus said with a loud voice, Paul, thou art beside thyself; much learning doth make thee mad.* While Paul was making his defense, Festus interrupted loudly: "You are out of your mind, Paul! Your great learning is driving you insane."
- 25 *But he said, I am not mad, most noble Festus; but speak forth the words of truth and soberness.* Paul replied, "I am not insane, most excellent Festus. What I am saying is true and reasonable.
- 26 *For the king knoweth of these things, before whom also I speak freely: for I am persuaded that none of these things are hidden from him; for this thing was not done in a corner.* The king knows about these things. I can speak freely to him. I am certain that none of this has escaped his notice, because it was not done in a corner.
- 27 *King Agrippa, believest thou the prophets? I know that thou believest.* King Agrippa, do you believe the prophets? I know that you believe."

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| <p>28 <i>Then Agrippa said unto Paul, Almost thou persuadest me to be a Christian.</i></p> <p>29 <i>And Paul said, I would to God, that not only thou, but also all that hear me this day, were both almost, and altogether such as I am, except these bonds.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And when he had thus spoken, the king rose up, and the governor, and Bernice, and they that sat with them:</i></p> <p>31 <i>And when they were gone aside, they talked between themselves, saying, This man doeth nothing worthy of death or of bonds.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Then said Agrippa unto Festus, This man might have been set at liberty, if he had not appealed unto Caesar.</i></p> | <p>Agrippa said to Paul, "Almost you persuade me to be a Christian."</p> <p>Paul replied, "I would to God that not only you but also all who hear me this day were both almost and altogether such as I am — except for these chains."</p> <p>The king rose to his feet, and with him the governor and Bernice and those sitting with them.</p> <p>After they withdrew, they talked to one another and said, "This man is not doing anything that deserves death or imprisonment."</p> <p>Agrippa said to Festus, "This man could have been set free if he had not appealed to Caesar."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Agrippa (*ah-GRIP-ah*) — King Herod Agrippa II before whom Paul made his defense in Acts 26 — he told Paul 'you almost persuade me to be a Christian.'

Festus (*FES-tus*) — The Roman governor who heard Paul's case after Felix — he found no Roman charge against Paul but offered to send him to Jerusalem; Paul appealed to Caesar.

Cross-References:

- v6 — Titus 2:13; Acts 24:15; Acts 28:20; Dan 7:13-14
- v8 — 1 Cor 15:12-20; Acts 17:31-32; Acts 4:2
- v9 — 1 Tim 1:13; Acts 22:8
- v10 — Acts 8:3; Acts 9:13-14; Acts 9:21
- v14 — Acts 21:40; Acts 9:7; Acts 22:2
- v16 — Acts 22:14-15; Dan 10:11; Ezek 2:1
- v17 — Acts 9:15; 1 Tim 2:7
- v18 — 1 Pet 2:9; Eph 1:18; Eph 5:8; Acts 20:32; Isa 42:7
- v19 — Isa 50:5; Ezek 2:7-8; Gal 1:16; Jer 20:9
- v20 — Acts 3:19; Matt 3:8; Acts 2:38; 2 Tim 2:25-26; Matt 9:13
- v23 — Isa 53:1-12; Luke 24:26; Rev 1:5; Col 1:18; Zech 12:10
- v24 — 1 Cor 2:13-14; 1 Cor 1:23; 1 Cor 4:10; 2 Cor 5:13; Mark 3:21

Chapter 27

Paul sailed for Rome as a prisoner and warned the crew that the voyage would end in disaster, but the centurion ignored him. A violent storm called Euroclydon drove the ship for fourteen days, and an angel told Paul that all aboard would be saved. The ship ran aground on the island of Melita, and all two hundred seventy-six souls escaped safely to land.

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| 1 <i>And when it was determined that we should sail into Italy, Paul and certain other prisoners were delivered unto one named Julius, a centurion of Augustus' band.</i> | When it was decided that we would sail for Italy, Paul and some other prisoners were handed over to a centurion named Julius, of the Imperial Regiment. |
| 2 <i>And entering into a ship of Adramyttium, we launched, meaning to sail by the coasts of Asia; one Aristarchus, a Macedonian of Thessalonica, being with us.</i> | We boarded a ship from Adramyttium that was about to sail to ports along the coast of Asia. Aristarchus, a Macedonian from Thessalonica, was with us. |
| 3 <i>And the next day we touched at Sidon. And Julius courteously entreated Paul, and gave him liberty to go unto his friends to refresh himself.</i> | The next day we put in at Sidon. Julius treated Paul kindly and allowed him to go to his friends and receive care. |
| 4 <i>And when we had launched from thence, we sailed under Cyprus, because the winds were contrary.</i> | From there we put out to sea again and sailed along the sheltered side of Cyprus, because the winds were against us. |
| 5 <i>And when we had sailed over the sea of Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came to Myra, a city of Lycia.</i> | When we had sailed across the open sea along the coast of Cilicia and Pamphylia, we reached Myra in Lycia. |
| 6 <i>And there the centurion found a ship of Alexandria sailing into Italy; and he put us therein.</i> | There the centurion found an Alexandrian ship sailing for Italy and put us on board. |
| 7 <i>And when we had sailed slowly many days, and scarce were come over against Cnidus, the wind not suffering us, we sailed under Crete, over against Salmone;</i> | We sailed slowly for many days and with difficulty arrived off Cnidus. The wind did not allow us to continue, so we sailed along the sheltered side of Crete, past Salmone. |

- 8 *And, hardly passing it, came unto a place which is called The fair havens; nigh whereunto was the city of Lasea.* We moved along the coast with difficulty and came to a place called Fair Havens, near the town of Lasea.
- 9 *Now when much time was spent, and when sailing was now dangerous, because the fast was now already past, Paul admonished them,* Much time had passed, and sailing had become dangerous because by now it was past the Day of Atonement. So Paul warned them,
- 10 *And said unto them, Sirs, I perceive that this voyage will be with hurt and much damage, not only of the lading and ship, but also of our lives.* "Men, I can see that this voyage is going to result in disaster and great loss — not only to the cargo and the ship, but to our own lives as well."
- 11 *Nevertheless the centurion believed the master and the owner of the ship, more than those things which were spoken by Paul.* But the centurion was persuaded more by the pilot and the ship's owner than by what Paul said.
- 12 *And because the haven was not commodious to winter in, the more part advised to depart thence also, if by any means they might attain to Phenice, and there to winter; which is an haven of Crete, and lieth toward the south west and north west.* Since the harbor was not suitable for wintering, most of the crew voted to sail on. They hoped to reach Phoenix and winter there — a harbor in Crete facing southwest and northwest.
- 13 *And when the south wind blew softly, supposing that they had obtained their purpose, loosing thence, they sailed close by Crete.* When a gentle south wind began to blow, they thought they had what they wanted. They weighed anchor and sailed along the coast of Crete.
- 14 *But not long after there arose against it a tempestuous wind, called Euroclydon.* But before long a violent wind called Euroclydon swept down from the island.
- 15 *And when the ship was caught, and could not bear up into the wind, we gave way to it, and were driven.* The ship was caught by the storm and could not face the wind, so we gave way to it and were driven along.

- 16 *And running under a certain island which is called Clauda, we had much work to come by the boat:* As we passed to the lee of a small island called Clauda, we were barely able to secure the lifeboat.
- 17 *Which when they had taken up, they used helps, undergirding the ship; and, fearing lest they should fall into the quicksands, strake sail, and so were driven.* When they had hoisted it up, they used ropes to brace the hull of the ship. Fearing they would run aground on the sandbars, they lowered the sea anchor and let the ship be driven along.
- 18 *And we being exceedingly tossed with a tempest, the next day they lightened the ship;* We were being violently battered by the storm, so the next day they began throwing the cargo overboard.
- 19 *And the third day we cast out with our own hands the tackling of the ship.* On the third day they threw the ship's tackle overboard with their own hands.
- 20 *And when neither sun nor stars in many days appeared, and no small tempest lay on us, all hope that we should be saved was then taken away.* When neither sun nor stars appeared for many days and the storm continued raging, we finally gave up all hope of being saved.
- 21 *But after long abstinence Paul stood forth in the midst of them, and said, Sirs, ye should have hearkened unto me, and not have loosed from Crete, and to have gained this harm and loss.* After the men had gone a long time without food, Paul stood up among them and said, "Men, you should have listened to me and not sailed from Crete. You would have avoided this damage and loss.
- 22 *And now I exhort you to be of good cheer: for there shall be no loss of any man's life among you, but of the ship.* But now I urge you to keep up your courage. Not one of you will lose his life — only the ship will be lost.
- 23 *For there stood by me this night the angel of God, whose I am, and whom I serve,* For last night an angel of the God to whom I belong and whom I serve stood beside me
- 24 *Saying, Fear not, Paul; thou must be brought before Caesar: and, lo, God hath given thee all them that sail with thee.* and said, 'Do not be afraid, Paul. You must stand before Caesar. God has graciously given you the lives of all who sail with you.'

- 25 *Wherefore, sirs, be of good cheer: for I believe God, that it shall be even as it was told me.* So keep up your courage, men. I believe God that it will happen exactly as He told me.
- 26 *Howbeit we must be cast upon a certain island.* But we must run aground on some island."
- 27 *But when the fourteenth night was come, as we were driven up and down in Adria, about midnight the shipmen deemed that they drew near to some country;* On the fourteenth night we were still being driven across the Adriatic Sea. About midnight the sailors sensed they were approaching land.
- 28 *And sounded, and found it twenty fathoms: and when they had gone a little further, they sounded again, and found it fifteen fathoms.* They took soundings and found the water was twenty fathoms deep. A short time later they took soundings again and found it was fifteen fathoms deep.
- 29 *Then fearing lest we should have fallen upon rocks, they cast four anchors out of the stern, and wished for the day.* Afraid that we would run aground on the rocks, they dropped four anchors from the stern and prayed for daylight.
- 30 *And as the shipmen were about to flee out of the ship, when they had let down the boat into the sea, under colour as though they would have cast anchors out of the foreship,* In an attempt to escape from the ship, the sailors lowered the lifeboat into the sea, pretending they were going to put out anchors from the bow.
- 31 *Paul said to the centurion and to the soldiers, Except these abide in the ship, ye cannot be saved.* But Paul said to the centurion and the soldiers, "Unless these men stay with the ship, you cannot be saved."
- 32 *Then the soldiers cut off the ropes of the boat, and let her fall off.* So the soldiers cut the ropes that held the lifeboat and let it fall away.
- 33 *And while the day was coming on, Paul besought them all to take meat, saying, This day is the fourteenth day that ye have tarried and continued fasting, having taken nothing.* Just before dawn Paul urged them all to eat. "For fourteen days," he said, "you have been in suspense and have gone without food — you have not eaten anything.

- 34 *Wherefore I pray you to take some meat: for this is for your health: for there shall not an hair fall from the head of any of you.* Now I urge you to eat something. You need it to survive. Not one of you will lose a single hair from his head."
- 35 *And when he had thus spoken, he took bread, and gave thanks to God in presence of them all: and when he had broken it, he began to eat.* After he said this, he took bread and gave thanks to God in front of them all. Then He broke it and began to eat.
- 36 *Then were they all of good cheer, and they also took some meat.* They were all encouraged and ate some food themselves.
- 37 *And we were in all in the ship two hundred threescore and sixteen souls.* There were 276 of us on the ship.
- 38 *And when they had eaten enough, they lightened the ship, and cast out the wheat into the sea.* When they had eaten as much as they wanted, they lightened the ship by throwing the grain into the sea.
- 39 *And when it was day, they knew not the land: but they discovered a certain creek with a shore, into the which they were minded, if it were possible, to thrust in the ship.* When daylight came, they did not recognize the land. But they saw a bay with a sandy beach, and they decided to run the ship aground there if they could.
- 40 *And when they had taken up the anchors, they committed themselves unto the sea, and loosed the rudder bands, and hoisted up the mainsail to the wind, and made toward shore.* They cut away the anchors and left them in the sea. At the same time they untied the ropes that held the rudders, hoisted the foresail to the wind, and headed for the beach.
- 41 *But striking into a place where two seas met, they ran the ship aground; and the forepart stuck fast, and remained unmoveable, but the hinder part was broken with the violence of the waves.* But they struck a sandbar and the ship ran aground. The bow stuck fast and would not move, while the stern was broken to pieces by the force of the waves.
- 42 *And the soldiers' counsel was to kill the prisoners, lest any of them should swim out, and escape.* The soldiers planned to kill the prisoners to prevent any of them from swimming away and escaping.

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| <p>43 <i>But the centurion, willing to save Paul, kept them from their purpose; and commanded that they which could swim should cast themselves first into the sea, and get to land:</i></p> <p>44 <i>And the rest, some on boards, and some on broken pieces of the ship. And so it came to pass, that they escaped all safe to land.</i></p> | <p>But the centurion wanted to spare Paul's life and kept them from carrying out their plan. He ordered those who could swim to jump overboard first and get to land.</p> <p>The rest followed, some on planks and some on pieces of the ship. In this way everyone reached land safely.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

prevent — To come before or precede — in the KJV, 'prevent' usually means 'get there first,' not 'stop from happening.'

strake — Peeled (past tense of 'streak') — in Genesis 30:37, Jacob 'straked' rods by peeling white streaks in them.

Day of Atonement — Yom Kippur — the holiest day of Israel's year; the only day the high priest entered the Most Holy Place to make atonement for the nation's sins.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 25:25; Acts 25:12; Acts 10:1
- v9 — Lev 23:27-29; Num 29:7
- v11 — Ezek 33:4; Ezek 3:17-18; Heb 11:7
- v18 — Jonah 1:5; Acts 27:38
- v20 — Matt 24:29; Matt 8:24-25
- v22 — Acts 27:36; Acts 27:25; Isa 43:1-2; Acts 27:34; Ps 112:7
- v23 — Acts 23:11; 2 Tim 4:17; Rom 1:9; Acts 5:19; Heb 1:14
- v24 — Acts 23:11; 2 Tim 4:16-17; Matt 10:28; Acts 9:15; Gen 19:29
- v25 — Rom 4:20-21; Luke 1:45; 2 Tim 1:12; Num 23:19; 2 Chr 20:20
- v31 — 2 Thess 2:13-14; Jer 29:11-13; Ps 91:11-12
- v34 — Matt 10:30; 1 Kgs 1:52; Luke 21:18
- v44 — Acts 27:22; Ps 107:28-30

Chapter 28

On Melita, Paul was bitten by a viper but suffered no harm, and he healed the father of Publius and many others on the island. Paul arrived at Rome and dwelt two whole years in his own hired house under guard, preaching the kingdom of God and teaching those things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ with all confidence, no man forbidding him.

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| 1 | <i>And when they were escaped, then they knew that the island was called Melita.</i> | Once we were safe, we learned that the island was called Melita. |
| 2 | <i>And the barbarous people shewed us no little kindness: for they kindled a fire, and received us every one, because of the present rain, and because of the cold.</i> | The native people showed us unusual kindness. They lit a fire and welcomed all of us, because it was raining and cold. |
| 3 | <i>And when Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks, and laid them on the fire, there came a viper out of the heat, and fastened on his hand.</i> | Paul gathered a pile of brushwood and laid it on the fire. A viper, driven out by the heat, fastened itself on his hand. |
| 4 | <i>And when the barbarians saw the venomous beast hang on his hand, they said among themselves, No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though he hath escaped the sea, yet vengeance suffereth him not to live.</i> | When the natives saw the snake hanging from his hand, they said to one another, "This man must be a murderer. Even though he escaped from the sea, justice has not allowed him to live." |
| 5 | <i>And he shook off the beast into the fire, and felt no harm.</i> | But Paul shook the snake off into the fire and suffered no harm. |
| 6 | <i>Howbeit they looked when he should have swollen, or fallen down dead suddenly: but after they had looked a great while, and saw no harm come to him, they changed their minds, and said that he was a god.</i> | The people expected him to swell up or suddenly fall down dead. But after waiting a long time and seeing nothing unusual happen to him, they changed their minds and said he was a god. |
| 7 | <i>In the same quarters were possessions of the chief man of the island, whose name was Publius; who received us, and lodged us three days courteously.</i> | Near that place was the estate of the leading man of the island, whose name was Publius. He welcomed us and showed us generous hospitality for three days. |

- 8 *And it came to pass, that the father of Publius lay sick of a fever and of a bloody flux: to whom Paul entered in, and prayed, and laid his hands on him, and healed him.* His father was sick in bed with fever and dysentery. Paul went in to see him. He prayed and laid his hands on the man and healed him.
- 9 *So when this was done, others also, which had diseases in the island, came, and were healed:* When this happened, the rest of the sick people on the island came and were healed.
- 10 *Who also honoured us with many honours; and when we departed, they laded us with such things as were necessary.* They honored us in many ways. When we were about to sail, they supplied us with everything we needed.
- 11 *And after three months we departed in a ship of Alexandria, which had wintered in the isle, whose sign was Castor and Pollux.* After three months we sailed in a ship of Alexandria that had wintered at the island, whose sign was Castor and Pollux.
- 12 *And landing at Syracuse, we tarried there three days.* We put in at Syracuse and stayed three days.
- 13 *And from thence we fetched a compass, and came to Rhegium: and after one day the south wind blew, and we came the next day to Puteoli:* From there we sailed around and arrived at Rhegium. After one day a south wind came up, and on the second day we came to Puteoli.
- 14 *Where we found brethren, and were desired to tarry with them seven days: and so we went toward Rome.* There we found brothers who invited us to stay with them for seven days. Then we went on toward Rome.
- 15 *And from thence, when the brethren heard of us, they came to meet us as far as Appii forum, and The three taverns: whom when Paul saw, he thanked God, and took courage.* The brothers there had heard about us and came to meet us as far as the Forum of Appius and Three Taverns. When Paul saw them, he thanked God and took courage.

- 16 *And when we came to Rome, the centurion delivered the prisoners to the captain of the guard: but Paul was suffered to dwell by himself with a soldier that kept him.* When we arrived in Rome, the centurion delivered the prisoners to the captain of the guard. Paul was allowed to live by himself with a soldier to guard him.
- 17 *And it came to pass, that after three days Paul called the chief of the Jews together: and when they were come together, he said unto them, Men and brethren, though I have committed nothing against the people, or customs of our fathers, yet was I delivered prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans.* Three days later Paul called together the local Jewish leaders. When they had gathered, he said to them, "Brothers, though I have done nothing against our people or the customs of our fathers, I was handed over to the Romans as a prisoner from Jerusalem.
- 18 *Who, when they had examined me, would have let me go, because there was no cause of death in me.* After examining me, they wanted to release me, because there was no charge against me that deserved death.
- 19 *But when the Jews spake against it, I was constrained to appeal unto Caesar; not that I had ought to accuse my nation of.* But when the Jews objected, I was forced to appeal to Caesar — not that I had any accusation to bring against my own nation.
- 20 *For this cause therefore have I called for you, to see you, and to speak with you: because that for the hope of Israel I am bound with this chain.* For this reason I have asked to see you and speak with you. It is because of the hope of Israel that I am wearing this chain."
- 21 *And they said unto him, We neither received letters out of Judaea concerning thee, neither any of the brethren that came shewed or spake any harm of thee.* They replied, "We have not received any letters from Judaea about you, nor have any of the brothers who have come here reported or said anything bad about you.
- 22 *But we desire to hear of thee what thou thinkest: for as concerning this sect, we know that every where it is spoken against.* But we want to hear what you think, for we know that people everywhere are speaking against this sect."

- 23 *And when they had appointed him a day, there came many to him into his lodging; to whom he expounded and testified the kingdom of God, persuading them concerning Jesus, both out of the law of Moses, and out of the prophets, from morning till evening.* They set a day to meet with Him, and a large number came to where He was staying. From morning until evening He explained and testified about the kingdom of God. He tried to persuade them about Jesus from both the Law of Moses and the Prophets.
- 24 *And some believed the things which were spoken, and some believed not.* Some were convinced by what He said, but others refused to believe.
- 25 *And when they agreed not among themselves, they departed, after that Paul had spoken one word, Well spake the Holy Ghost by Esaias the prophet unto our fathers,* They disagreed among themselves and began to leave. Paul said one final word: "The Holy Ghost spoke the truth to your fathers through the prophet Isaiah
- 26 *Saying, Go unto this people, and say, Hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and not perceive:* when he said, 'Go to this people and say, "You will be ever hearing but never understanding; you will be ever seeing but never perceiving."
- 27 *For the heart of this people is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes have they closed; lest they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.* For the heart of this people has grown dull. Their ears can barely hear, and they have shut their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn — and I would heal them.'
- 28 *Be it known therefore unto you, that the salvation of God is sent unto the Gentiles, and that they will hear it.* Therefore let it be known to you that God's salvation has been sent to the Gentiles. They will listen!"
- 29 *And when he had said these words, the Jews departed, and had great reasoning among themselves.* When he had said these words, the Jews left, debating vigorously among themselves.

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| 30 | <i>And Paul dwelt two whole years in his own hired house, and received all that came in unto him,</i> | Paul lived for two full years in his own rented house and welcomed all who came to visit him. |
| 31 | <i>Preaching the kingdom of God, and teaching those things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ, with all confidence, no man forbidding him.</i> | He proclaimed the kingdom of God and taught about the Lord Jesus Christ with all boldness and without any hindrance. |
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Words in this chapter:

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v2 — Rom 1:14; Heb 13:2; Col 3:11
- v4 — Luke 13:2; Luke 13:4
- v5 — Luke 10:19; Mark 16:18; Ps 91:13
- v8 — Acts 9:40; Mark 6:5; Matt 9:18; Jas 5:14-16
- v16 — Acts 27:3; Acts 24:23
- v20 — Acts 26:6-7; 2 Tim 2:9; Eph 6:20
- v22 — Acts 24:14; 1 Pet 2:12
- v25 — Matt 15:7; 2 Pet 1:21; Mark 7:6
- v26 — Isa 6:9-10; Ezek 12:2; Isa 42:19-20; Matt 13:14-15; Mark 4:12
- v27 — Isa 6:10
- v28 — Luke 2:30-32; Acts 26:17-18; Luke 3:6; Rom 3:29-30; Rom 15:8-16
- v31 — Acts 4:29; Eph 6:19-20; Acts 28:23; Matt 4:23; Acts 8:12

Romans

Author: Paul the apostle — the opening verse names him, and the personal details throughout (especially ch. 16) are consistent with his other letters. Tertius served as his scribe (16:22).

Date written: c. AD 57, from Corinth, during Paul's third missionary journey, before his final visit to Jerusalem.

Written to: The church at Rome — a congregation Paul had not yet visited, composed of both Jewish and Gentile believers.

Setting: Paul is planning his first visit to Rome and wants to prepare the church theologically, then use Rome as a base for a mission to Spain. He writes his most systematic letter as an introduction to his gospel.

Where this sits historically: Written under Nero in the relatively peaceful early years of his reign, just years after Claudius had expelled the Jews from Rome (AD 49) and shortly before Paul's arrest in Jerusalem.

Contemporaries: Paul wrote alongside the composition of 1–2 Corinthians, while Phebe of Cenchrea, Aquila, Priscilla, Timothy, and many others named in chapter 16 were active in the gospel mission.

Big themes:

- The righteousness of God — all have sinned and fall short; God provides righteousness as a free gift through faith in Christ
- Justification by faith alone — Abraham was justified by faith before circumcision (ch. 4); the law cannot save, only condemn; faith in Christ is the only basis of acceptance before God
- The wrath of God — chapters 1–3 establish that all mankind is under divine judgment; the good news requires this bad news as its foundation
- Sanctification — chapters 6–8 address the believer's life: dead to sin, alive to God, walking by the Spirit
- God's sovereign plan for Israel and the Gentiles — chapters 9–11 are the most thorough NT treatment of election, Israel's hardening, and the future of the Jewish people

Key passages: Rom 1:16–17; 3:23–24; 5:8; 6:23; 8:28; 10:9–10

How it fits: Romans is the NT's fullest systematic statement of the gospel. Luther called it "the chief part of the New Testament and the very purest gospel." It is the theological foundation on which Galatians, Ephesians, and all of Paul's other letters rest. No book in the NT has done more to shape Christian doctrine.

Chapter 1

Paul introduces himself and declares that the gospel is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes. He argues that God's wrath is revealed against all ungodliness, because men suppress the truth and worship the creature rather than the Creator, and God gives them over to a reprobate mind.

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| <p>1 <i>Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ, called to be an apostle, separated unto the gospel of God,</i></p> <p>2 <i>(Which he had promised afore by his prophets in the holy scriptures,)</i></p> <p>3 <i>Concerning his Son Jesus Christ our Lord, which was made of the seed of David according to the flesh;</i></p> <p>4 <i>And declared to be the Son of God with power, according to the spirit of holiness, by the resurrection from the dead:</i></p> <p>5 <i>By whom we have received grace and apostleship, for obedience to the faith among all nations, for his name:</i></p> <p>6 <i>Among whom are ye also the called of Jesus Christ:</i></p> <p>7 <i>To all that be in Rome, beloved of God, called to be saints: Grace to you and peace from God our Father, and the Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>8 <i>First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for you all, that your faith is spoken of throughout the whole world.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For God is my witness, whom I serve with my spirit in the gospel of his Son, that without ceasing I make mention of you always in my prayers;</i></p> | <p>Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ, called as an apostle, set apart for the gospel of God—</p> <p>which He promised beforehand through His prophets in the holy scriptures—</p> <p>concerning His Son, Jesus Christ our Lord, who was descended from David according to the flesh,</p> <p>and declared to be the Son of God with power, according to the Spirit of holiness, by the resurrection from the dead.</p> <p>Through Him we have received grace and apostleship to bring about obedience of faith among all nations for His name's sake.</p> <p>You also are among those who are called by Jesus Christ.</p> <p>To all in Rome who are beloved of God, called to be saints: grace to You and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.</p> <p>First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for all of You, because Your faith is proclaimed throughout the whole world.</p> <p>God is my witness — whom I serve with my spirit in the gospel of His Son — that without ceasing I mention You always in my prayers,</p> |
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- 10 *Making request, if by any means now at length I might have a prosperous journey by the will of God to come unto you.* asking that somehow, by God's will, I may at last succeed in coming to You.
- 11 *For I long to see you, that I may impart unto you some spiritual gift, to the end ye may be established;* I long to see You, so that I may share some spiritual gift to strengthen You—
- 12 *That is, that I may be comforted together with you by the mutual faith both of you and me.* that is, that we may be mutually encouraged by each other's faith, both Yours and mine.
- 13 *Now I would not have you ignorant, brethren, that oftentimes I purposed to come unto you, (but was let hitherto,) that I might have some fruit among you also, even as among other Gentiles.* I do not want You to be unaware, brothers, that I have often intended to come to You but have been hindered until now, so that I might have some fruit among You as well as among the rest of the Gentiles.
- 14 *I am debtor both to the Greeks, and to the Barbarians; both to the wise, and to the unwise.* I am under obligation both to Greeks and to non-Greeks, both to the wise and to the foolish.
- 15 *So, as much as in me is, I am ready to preach the gospel to you that are at Rome also.* So I am eager to preach the gospel to You also who are in Rome.
- 16 *For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.* I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes — to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.
- 17 *For therein is the righteousness of God revealed from faith to faith: as it is written, The just shall live by faith.* In it the righteousness of God is revealed from faith to faith, as it is written: "The just shall live by faith."
- 18 *For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who hold the truth in unrighteousness;* The wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men who suppress the truth in unrighteousness.

- 19 *Because that which may be known of God is manifest in them; for God hath shewed it unto them.* What can be known about God is plain to them, for God has shown it to them.
- 20 *For the invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead; so that they are without excuse:* His invisible qualities — His eternal power and Godhead — have been clearly seen since the creation of the world, understood through what has been made. So they are without excuse.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Godhead** (GOD-hed) — the divine nature of God; the Trinity considered as one being. When Paul says God's "Godhead" is seen in creation, he means the very essence of what God is — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit — is visible in the things He made.

- 21 *Because that, when they knew God, they glorified him not as God, neither were thankful; but became vain in their imaginations, and their foolish heart was darkened.* Although they knew God, they did not honor Him as God or give thanks to Him. Their thinking became worthless, and their foolish hearts were darkened.
- 22 *Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools,* Claiming to be wise, they became fools.
- 23 *And changed the glory of the uncorruptible God into an image made like to corruptible man, and to birds, and fourfooted beasts, and creeping things.* They exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images made to look like mortal man, birds, four-footed animals, and reptiles.
- 24 *Wherefore God also gave them up to uncleanness through the lusts of their own hearts, to dishonour their own bodies between themselves:* Therefore God gave them over to the impure desires of their hearts, to dishonoring their bodies among themselves.
- 25 *Who changed the truth of God into a lie, and worshipped and served the creature more than the Creator, who is blessed for ever. Amen.* They exchanged the truth of God for a lie and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, Who is blessed forever. Amen.

- 26 *For this cause God gave them up unto vile affections: for even their women did change the natural use into that which is against nature:* For this reason God gave them over to vile affections. Even their women exchanged natural relations for those that are contrary to nature.
- 27 *And likewise also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust one toward another; men with men working that which is unseemly, and receiving in themselves that recompence of their error which was met.* In the same way the men abandoned natural relations with women and burned with desire for one another. Men committed shameful acts with men and received in themselves the due penalty for their error.
- 28 *And even as they did not like to retain God in their knowledge, God gave them over to a reprobate mind, to do those things which are not convenient;* Since they did not see fit to acknowledge God, He gave them over to a corrupt mind to do things that should not be done.
- 29 *Being filled with all unrighteousness, fornication, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, debate, deceit, malignity; whisperers,* They are filled with every kind of unrighteousness, fornication, wickedness, greed, evil, envy, murder, strife, deceit, and malice. They are gossips,
- 30 *Backbiters, haters of God, despiteful, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents,* slanderers, God-haters, insolent, arrogant, and boastful. They invent new forms of evil and disobey their parents.
- 31 *Without understanding, covenantbreakers, without natural affection, implacable, unmerciful:* They have no sense, break their covenants, have no natural affection, are implacable, and show no mercy.
- 32 *Who knowing the judgment of God, that they which commit such things are worthy of death, not only do the same, but have pleasure in them that do them.* Though they know God's decree — that those who do such things deserve death — they not only do them but approve of others who practice them.

Words in this chapter:

godhead — The divine nature of God — the Trinity considered as one being; God in His full divine essence.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Rome (*ROME*) — Capital of the Roman Empire — Paul wrote his letter to the Romans to the church there; he was eventually imprisoned and martyred in Rome.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 9:15; Rom 15:16; 1 Cor 1:1; Jer 1:5; Col 1:1
- v2 — Titus 1:2; Luke 1:70; Rom 3:21; Rom 16:26; Rom 3:2
- v3 — Gal 4:4; Matt 1:1; Jer 23:5-6; John 1:14; Luke 1:31-33
- v16 — Mark 8:38; 2 Tim 1:8; 1 Pet 4:16; 2 Tim 1:12; Ps 40:9-10
- v17 — Hab 2:4; Gal 3:11; Heb 10:38; Phil 3:9; Heb 11:6-7
- v18 — Eph 5:6; 1 Tim 4:1-2; Rom 1:32; Col 3:6; 2 Thess 2:10
- v19 — Acts 14:16-17; Rom 1:20; Ps 19:1-6; Acts 17:23-30; Isa 40:26
- v20 — Rom 1:19; Isa 40:26; Ps 19:1-6; Ps 8:3; Ps 33:6-9
- v21 — Eph 4:17-18; 2 Kgs 17:15; Jer 2:5; 2 Tim 3:2; Ps 50:23
- v24 — Ps 81:11-12; Acts 7:42; Matt 15:14; Acts 14:16; 2 Thess 2:10-12
- v26 — Jude 1:7; 1 Tim 1:10; Lev 18:22-28; Rom 1:24; 1 Cor 6:9
- v28 — 2 Thess 2:10-12; Rom 1:21; Titus 1:16; Jer 9:6; Rom 1:24

Chapter 2

Paul argues that the moralist who judges others is equally guilty before God, because God judges impartially according to truth. He warns that the Jew who boasts in the law yet breaks it dishonors God, and that true circumcision is of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter.

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| <p>1 <i>Therefore thou art inexcusable, O man, whosoever thou art that judgest: for wherein thou judgest another, thou condemnest thyself; for thou that judgest doest the same things.</i></p> | <p>Therefore You are without excuse, O man, whoever you are who judges. When you judge another, You condemn Yourself, because You who judge do the same things.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>But we are sure that the judgment of God is according to truth against them which commit such things.</i></p> | <p>We know that God's judgment against those who do such things is according to truth.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And thinkest thou this, O man, that judgest them which do such things, and doest the same, that thou shalt escape the judgment of God?</i></p> | <p>Do You suppose, O man — you who judge those who do such things and yet do them Yourself — that You will escape the judgment of God?</p> |

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| <p>4 <i>Or despisest thou the riches of his goodness and forbearance and longsuffering; not knowing that the goodness of God leadeth thee to repentance?</i></p> | <p>Or do You despise the riches of His goodness, forbearance, and longsuffering, not knowing that God's kindness is meant to lead You to repentance?</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. When God is longsuffering, He holds back His judgment, giving sinners time to repent. It is not weakness — it is deliberate, patient mercy.

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| <p>5 <i>But after thy hardness and impenitent heart treasurest up unto thyself wrath against the day of wrath and revelation of the righteous judgment of God;</i></p> | <p>But because of Your hard and unrepentant heart You are storing up wrath for Yourself on the day of wrath, when God's righteous judgment will be revealed.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Who will render to every man according to his deeds:</i></p> | <p>He will repay each person according to what He has done.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>To them who by patient continuance in well doing seek for glory and honour and immortality, eternal life:</i></p> | <p>To those who by patient endurance in doing good seek glory, honor, and immortality, He will give eternal life.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>But unto them that are contentious, and do not obey the truth, but obey unrighteousness, indignation and wrath,</i></p> | <p>But to those who are self-seeking and do not obey the truth but obey unrighteousness, there will be wrath and fury.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Tribulation and anguish, upon every soul of man that doeth evil, of the Jew first, and also of the Gentile;</i></p> | <p>There will be tribulation and anguish for every soul of man who does evil — for the Jew first and also for the Gentile.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>But glory, honour, and peace, to every man that worketh good, to the Jew first, and also to the Gentile:</i></p> | <p>But there will be glory, honor, and peace for everyone who does good — for the Jew first and also for the Gentile.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>For there is no respect of persons with God.</i></p> | <p>For God shows no partiality.</p> |

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| <p>12 <i>For as many as have sinned without law shall also perish without law: and as many as have sinned in the law shall be judged by the law;</i></p> | <p>All who have sinned without the law will also perish without the law, and all who have sinned under the law will be judged by the law.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>(For not the hearers of the law are just before God, but the doers of the law shall be justified.</i></p> | <p>For it is not the hearers of the law who are righteous before God, but the doers of the law who will be justified.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>For when the Gentiles, which have not the law, do by nature the things contained in the law, these, having not the law, are a law unto themselves:</i></p> | <p>When Gentiles who do not have the law do by nature the things required by the law, they are a law to themselves, even though they do not have the law.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>Which shew the work of the law written in their hearts, their conscience also bearing witness, and their thoughts the mean while accusing or else excusing one another;)</i></p> | <p>They show that the work of the law is written on their hearts. Their conscience also bears witness, and their thoughts either accuse or defend them.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>In the day when God shall judge the secrets of men by Jesus Christ according to my gospel.</i></p> | <p>This will happen on the day when God judges the secrets of men through Jesus Christ, according to my gospel.</p> |
| <p>17 <i>Behold, thou art called a Jew, and retest in the law, and makest thy boast of God,</i></p> | <p>Now if You call Yourself a Jew and rely on the law and boast in God—</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And knowest his will, and approvest the things that are more excellent, being instructed out of the law;</i></p> | <p>if You know His will and approve what is excellent because You are instructed from the law—</p> |
| <p>19 <i>And art confident that thou thyself art a guide of the blind, a light of them which are in darkness,</i></p> | <p>if You are confident that You are a guide to the blind, a light to those in darkness,</p> |
| <p>20 <i>An instructor of the foolish, a teacher of babes, which hast the form of knowledge and of the truth in the law.</i></p> | <p>an instructor of the foolish, a teacher of children, having in the law the pattern of knowledge and truth—</p> |

- 21 *Thou therefore which teachest another, teachest thou not thyself? thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal?* you then who teach others — do You not teach Yourself? You who preach against stealing, do You steal?
- 22 *Thou that sayest a man should not commit adultery, dost thou commit adultery? thou that abhorrest idols, dost thou commit sacrilege?* You who say one should not commit adultery, do You commit adultery? You who hate idols, do You rob temples?
- 23 *Thou that makest thy boast of the law, through breaking the law dishonourest thou God?* You who boast in the law, do You dishonor God by breaking the law?
- 24 *For the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles through you, as it is written.* "The name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles because of You," as it is written.
- 25 *For circumcision verily profiteth, if thou keep the law: but if thou be a breaker of the law, thy circumcision is made uncircumcision.* Circumcision has value if You obey the law, but if You break the law, Your circumcision has become uncircumcision.
- 26 *Therefore if the uncircumcision keep the righteousness of the law, shall not his uncircumcision be counted for circumcision?* So if a man who is uncircumcised keeps the requirements of the law, will not His uncircumcision be counted as circumcision?
- 27 *And shall not uncircumcision which is by nature, if it fulfil the law, judge thee, who by the letter and circumcision dost transgress the law?* The one who is physically uncircumcised but keeps the law will judge You who, with Your written code and circumcision, are a lawbreaker.
- 28 *For he is not a Jew, which is one outwardly; neither is that circumcision, which is outward in the flesh:* A person is not a Jew who is one outwardly, nor is circumcision something outward in the flesh.

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But he is a Jew, which is one inwardly; and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit, and not in the letter; whose praise is not of men, but of God.
- A person is a Jew who is one inwardly, and circumcision is of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter. Such a person's praise is not from men but from God.

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 6:37; Rom 2:3; John 8:7-9; Rom 2:21-23; Rom 1:18-20
- v4 — 2 Pet 3:9; Isa 30:18; Ex 34:6; Titus 3:4-6; Rom 9:22-23
- v5 — Eccl 12:14; Rom 1:18; Rom 2:2-3; Heb 3:15; Jude 1:6
- v6 — Ps 62:12; Jer 32:19; Matt 16:27; 2 Cor 5:10; Jer 17:10
- v7 — 2 Tim 4:7-8; Luke 8:15; 1 Cor 15:58; 2 Tim 1:10; Rev 2:10-11
- v11 — Deut 10:17; Acts 10:34; 2 Chr 19:7; Gal 2:6; Gal 6:7-8
- v13 — Jas 1:22-25; 1 John 3:7; Jas 2:21-25; Rom 2:25; Gal 2:16
- v14 — Rom 1:19-20; Rom 2:12; Rom 2:27; Acts 17:30; Ps 147:19-20
- v16 — Eccl 12:14; 1 Cor 4:5; Acts 17:31; Acts 10:42; Luke 8:17
- v24 — Ezek 36:20-23; Isa 52:5; 2 Pet 2:2
- v28 — Gal 6:15; Matt 3:9; Rom 9:6-8; Rev 2:9; Isa 48:1-2
- v29 — Deut 30:6; Phil 3:3; Deut 10:16; Col 2:11-12; Jer 4:4

Chapter 3

Paul concludes that all people — Jew and Gentile — are under sin and that no flesh is justified by the deeds of the law. The righteousness of God comes through faith in Jesus Christ to all who believe, and God set forth Christ as a propitiation through His blood.

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What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision?
- What advantage has the Jew? Or what is the value of circumcision?
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Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God.
- Much in every way. First, the Jews were entrusted with the oracles of God.
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For what if some did not believe? shall their unbelief make the faith of God without effect?
- What if some were unfaithful? Does their unfaithfulness cancel out the faithfulness of God?

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| <p>4 <i>God forbid: yea, let God be true, but every man a liar; as it is written, That thou mightest be justified in thy sayings, and mightest overcome when thou art judged.</i></p> <p>5 <i>But if our unrighteousness commend the righteousness of God, what shall we say? Is God unrighteous who taketh vengeance? (I speak as a man)</i></p> <p>6 <i>God forbid: for then how shall God judge the world?</i></p> <p>7 <i>For if the truth of God hath more abounded through my lie unto his glory; why yet am I also judged as a sinner?</i></p> <p>8 <i>And not rather, (as we be slanderously reported, and as some affirm that we say,) Let us do evil, that good may come? whose damnation is just.</i></p> | <p>Not at all! Let God be true though every man a liar, as it is written: "That you may be justified in Your words, and prevail when You are judged."</p> <p>But if our unrighteousness highlights the righteousness of God, what shall we say? That God is unrighteous in bringing His wrath? I am speaking in human terms.</p> <p>Not at all! For then how could God judge the world?</p> <p>But if through my lie God's truth abounds to His glory, why am I still condemned as a sinner?</p> <p>And why not do evil so that good may come — as some slander us by saying that we preach? Their damnation is just.</p> |
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- **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. When Paul says "their damnation is just," he means those who twist the gospel into a license for sin deserve God's condemnation.
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| <p>9 <i>What then? are we better than they? No, in no wise: for we have before proved both Jews and Gentiles, that they are all under sin;</i></p> <p>10 <i>As it is written, There is none righteous, no, not one:</i></p> <p>11 <i>There is none that understandeth, there is none that seeketh after God.</i></p> | <p>What then? Are we Jews any better off? No, not at all. We have already charged that both Jews and Greeks are all under sin,</p> <p>as it is written: "There is no one righteous, not even one.</p> <p>There is no one who understands. There is no one who seeks after God.</p> |
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- 12 *They are all gone out of the way, they are together become unprofitable; there is none that doeth good, no, not one.* All have turned away. Together they have become worthless. There is no one who does good — not even one."
- 13 *Their throat is an open sepulchre; with their tongues they have used deceit; the poison of asps is under their lips:* "Their throat is an open grave. With their tongues they have practiced deceit. The poison of asps is under their lips."
- 14 *Whose mouth is full of cursing and bitterness:* "Their mouth is full of cursing and bitterness."
- 15 *Their feet are swift to shed blood:* "Their feet are swift to shed blood."
- 16 *Destruction and misery are in their ways:* "Ruin and misery are in their paths."
- 17 *And the way of peace have they not known:* "The way of peace they have not known."
- 18 *There is no fear of God before their eyes.* "There is no fear of God before their eyes."
- 19 *Now we know that what things soever the law saith, it saith to them who are under the law: that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God.* Now we know that whatever the law says, it says to those who are under the law, so that every mouth may be silenced and the whole world held accountable to God.
- 20 *Therefore by the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified in his sight: for by the law is the knowledge of sin.* Therefore no flesh will be justified in His sight by works of the law, for through the law comes the knowledge of sin.
- 21 *But now the righteousness of God without the law is manifested, being witnessed by the law and the prophets;* But now the righteousness of God has been revealed apart from the law, though the law and the prophets testify to it.
- 22 *Even the righteousness of God which is by faith of Jesus Christ unto all and upon all them that believe: for there is no difference:* This righteousness of God comes through faith in Jesus Christ to all who believe. There is no distinction,

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| 23 | <i>For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;</i> | for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God. |
| 24 | <i>Being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus:</i> | They are justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Justified** (JUS-tih-fyde) — *being declared not guilty by God; legally counted as righteous because of Christ. Justification is God's verdict: "Not guilty." It is not earned — it is received by faith.*

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (rih-DEMP-shun) — *to buy back, to set free by paying a price. Christ's death was the ransom price that purchased our freedom from sin and its penalty.*

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| 25 | <i>Whom God hath set forth to be a propitiation through faith in his blood, to declare his righteousness for the remission of sins that are past, through the forbearance of God;</i> | God set Him forth to be a propitiation through faith in His blood, to declare His righteousness for the remission of sins that are past, through the forbearance of God. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Propitiation** (proh-PISH-ee-AY-shun) — *the sacrifice that satisfies God's just anger against sin. When Paul says Jesus is our propitiation, he means Christ took the punishment we deserved so God's wrath against our sin was fully paid.*

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| 26 | <i>To declare, I say, at this time his righteousness: that he might be just, and the justifier of him which believeth in Jesus.</i> | He did this to demonstrate His righteousness at the present time — that He is just and the one who justifies the person who has faith in Jesus. |
| 27 | <i>Where is boasting then? It is excluded. By what law? of works? Nay: but by the law of faith.</i> | Where, then, is boasting? It is excluded. By what kind of law? By a law of works? No, but by the law of faith. |
| 28 | <i>Therefore we conclude that a man is justified by faith without the deeds of the law.</i> | We conclude that a person is justified by faith apart from works of the law. |
| 29 | <i>Is he the God of the Jews only? is he not also of the Gentiles? Yes, of the Gentiles also:</i> | Or is God the God of Jews only? Is He not also the God of Gentiles? Yes, of Gentiles also— |

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| <p>30 <i>Seeing it is one God, which shall justify the circumcision by faith, and uncircumcision through faith.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Do we then make void the law through faith? God forbid: yea, we establish the law.</i></p> | <p>since God is one. He will justify the circumcised by faith and the uncircumcised through faith.</p> <p>Do we then overthrow the law by this faith? Not at all! On the contrary, we uphold the law.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

propitiation — The sacrifice that satisfies God's just anger against sin — Christ took the punishment we deserved so God's wrath was fully paid.

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

Cross-References:

- v3 — 2 Tim 2:13; Heb 4:2; Rom 9:6; Titus 1:1-2; Isa 55:11
v4 — Ps 51:4; Ps 116:11; Gal 2:17; Heb 6:18; Deut 32:4
v10 — Ps 53:1-3; Ps 14:1-3; Rom 3:23; 1 John 1:8-10; Job 15:14
v11 — Ps 14:2-4; Ps 53:2; Titus 3:3; Hos 4:6; Rom 8:7
v13 — Ps 5:9; Ps 140:3; Matt 23:27-28; Jer 9:3-5; Ps 57:4
v19 — Gal 3:10; Gal 3:22-23; Rom 2:12-18; Rom 3:9; Gal 5:18
v20 — Gal 2:16; Acts 13:39; Rom 3:28; Gal 2:19; Rom 4:15
v21 — Acts 10:43; Jer 33:16; Phil 3:9; Jer 23:5-6; Isa 51:8
v22 — Rom 10:12; Gal 3:28; Gal 2:16; Rom 8:1; Col 3:11
v23 — Eccl 7:20; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom 3:9; Gal 3:22; Rom 11:32
v24 — 1 Pet 1:18-19; Titus 3:5-7; Col 1:14; Eph 1:6-7; Rom 5:9
v25 — Rom 3:23-24; 1 Pet 1:18-20; 1 John 4:10; 1 John 2:2; Rom 5:9

Chapter 4

Paul argues that Abraham was justified by faith, not works, and that his faith was counted to him for righteousness before he was circumcised. The promise came through the righteousness of faith so that it might be by grace and be sure to all the seed — not to those of the law only, but to all who share Abraham's faith.

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| <p>1 <i>What shall we say then that Abraham our father, as pertaining to the flesh, hath found?</i></p> | <p>What then shall we say was gained by Abraham, our forefather according to the flesh?</p> |
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| 2 | <i>For if Abraham were justified by works, he hath whereof to glory; but not before God.</i> | If Abraham was justified by works, he has something to boast about — but not before God. |
| 3 | <i>For what saith the scripture? Abraham believed God, and it was counted unto him for righteousness.</i> | What does the scripture say?
"Abraham believed God, and it was counted to Him as righteousness." |
| 4 | <i>Now to him that worketh is the reward not reckoned of grace, but of debt.</i> | Now to one who works, his wages are not counted as a gift but as something owed. |
| 5 | <i>But to him that worketh not, but believeth on him that justifieth the ungodly, his faith is counted for righteousness.</i> | But to one who does not work but believes in Him who justifies the ungodly, his faith is counted as righteousness. |
| 6 | <i>Even as David also describeth the blessedness of the man, unto whom God imputeth righteousness without works,</i> | David also describes the blessedness of the man to whom God imputes righteousness apart from works: |
| 7 | <i>Saying, Blessed are they whose iniquities are forgiven, and whose sins are covered.</i> | "Blessed are those whose iniquities are forgiven, and whose sins are covered. |
| 8 | <i>Blessed is the man to whom the Lord will not impute sin.</i> | Blessed is the man to whom the Lord will not impute sin." |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Imputed** (im-PYOO-ted) — credited to your account. Our sin was charged to Christ; His righteousness is credited to us. When God imputes righteousness, He counts it as ours even though we did not earn it.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (in-IK-wih-tee) — deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. Iniquity is not just what you do wrong, but the bent nature inside you that drives it.

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| 9 | <i>Cometh this blessedness then upon the circumcision only, or upon the uncircumcision also? for we say that faith was reckoned to Abraham for righteousness.</i> | Is this blessing only for the circumcised, or also for the uncircumcised? We say that faith was counted to Abraham as righteousness. |
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| <p>10 <i>How was it then reckoned? when he was in circumcision, or in uncircumcision? Not in circumcision, but in uncircumcision.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And he received the sign of circumcision, a seal of the righteousness of the faith which he had yet being uncircumcised: that he might be the father of all them that believe, though they be not circumcised; that righteousness might be imputed unto them also:</i></p> <p>12 <i>And the father of circumcision to them who are not of the circumcision only, but who also walk in the steps of that faith of our father Abraham, which he had being yet uncircumcised.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For the promise, that he should be the heir of the world, was not to Abraham, or to his seed, through the law, but through the righteousness of faith.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For if they which are of the law be heirs, faith is made void, and the promise made of none effect:</i></p> <p>15 <i>Because the law worketh wrath: for where no law is, there is no transgression.</i></p> | <p>How then was it counted? Was it before or after he was circumcised? It was not after but before he was circumcised.</p> <p>He received the sign of circumcision as a seal of the righteousness that he had by faith while still uncircumcised. The purpose was to make him the father of all who believe without being circumcised, so that righteousness might be imputed to them also.</p> <p>He is also the father of the circumcised who are not merely circumcised but who also walk in the footsteps of the faith that our father Abraham had before he was circumcised.</p> <p>The promise to Abraham and his seed that he would inherit the world did not come through the law but through the righteousness of faith.</p> <p>If it is those who follow the law who are heirs, then faith is useless and the promise is nullified.</p> <p>For the law brings wrath, but where there is no law there is no transgression.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. While sin is missing the mark, transgression is knowingly stepping over the boundary God established.

- 16 *Therefore it is of faith, that it might be by grace; to the end the promise might be sure to all the seed; not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham; who is the father of us all,* Therefore the promise comes by faith so that it may rest on grace, and be guaranteed to all Abraham's seed — not only to those under the law but also to those who share Abraham's faith, for he is the father of us all—
- 17 *(As it is written, I have made thee a father of many nations,) before him whom he believed, even God, who quickeneth the dead, and calleth those things which be not as though they were.* as it is written: "I have made you a father of many nations." He is our father in the sight of God, in whom He believed — the God Who quickens the dead and calls into existence things that do not exist.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Quickened** (KWIK-end) — *made alive; spiritually brought from death to life by God. When God quickens, He gives life where there was none — to dead bodies, and to dead souls. It is not revival of something fading; it is resurrection power.*

- 18 *Who against hope believed in hope, that he might become the father of many nations, according to that which was spoken, So shall thy seed be.* Against all hope, Abraham in hope believed and so became the father of many nations, just as it had been said to him: "So shall your seed be."
- 19 *And being not weak in faith, he considered not his own body now dead, when he was about an hundred years old, neither yet the deadness of Sara's womb:* He did not weaken in faith when he considered his own body, which was as good as dead (he was about a hundred years old), or when he considered the deadness of Sarah's womb.
- 20 *He staggered not at the promise of God through unbelief; but was strong in faith, giving glory to God;* He did not waver in unbelief regarding the promise of God, but grew strong in faith, giving glory to God.
- 21 *And being fully persuaded that, what he had promised, he was able also to perform.* He was fully convinced that God was able to do what He had promised.
- 22 *And therefore it was imputed to him for righteousness.* And therefore it was imputed to him for righteousness.
- 23 *Now it was not written for his sake alone, that it was imputed to him;* Now it was not written for his sake alone that it was imputed to him,

24	<i>But for us also, to whom it shall be imputed, if we believe on him that raised up Jesus our Lord from the dead;</i>	but for us also, to whom it shall be imputed, if we believe in Him who raised up Jesus our Lord from the dead —
25	<i>Who was delivered for our offences, and was raised again for our justification.</i>	He was delivered over for our sins and raised for our justification.

Words in this chapter:

- imputed** — Credited to your account — our sin charged to Christ, His righteousness counted as ours.
- justification** — Being declared not guilty by God — legally counted as righteous because of Christ's perfect record credited to the believer.
- Sarah** (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Cor 1:31; 2 Cor 11:30; Phil 3:9; Gal 3:22; Eph 2:9
- v3 — Gen 15:6; Jas 2:23; Gal 3:6-8; Rom 4:9; Rom 4:22-25
- v5 — Phil 3:9; Rom 3:22; Titus 3:3-7; Rom 10:9-10; Gal 3:8-14
- v6 — 2 Tim 1:9; Phil 3:9; Eph 2:8-10; Gal 3:8-9; 1 Cor 1:30
- v7 — Ps 32:1-2; Ps 130:3-4; Luke 7:47-50; Mic 7:18-20; Ps 85:2
- v13 — Gal 3:29; Gen 28:14; Rom 9:8; Gen 22:17-18; Ps 2:8
- v15 — Rom 5:13; Gal 3:10; Rom 3:19-20; 1 Cor 15:56; Rom 7:7-25
- v17 — 1 Cor 1:28; Gen 17:4-5; John 5:21; Rom 8:29-30; John 6:63
- v18 — Rom 8:24; Gen 15:5-6; Rom 5:5; Acts 27:25; Prov 13:12
- v20 — Luke 1:45; 1 Cor 16:13; 2 Cor 12:10; Dan 10:19; 2 Tim 2:1
- v21 — Luke 1:37; Jer 32:27; Jer 32:17; Heb 11:19; Luke 1:45
- v25 — 1 John 4:9-10; Isa 53:5-6; 2 Cor 5:21; Gal 1:4; 1 Pet 3:18

Chapter 5

Paul declares that being justified by faith brings peace with God and access to His grace. He argues that as sin and death entered the world through Adam, much more does the free gift of righteousness and life abound through Jesus Christ to all who receive it.

1	<i>Therefore being justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ:</i>	Therefore, having been justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ.
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| <p>2 <i>By whom also we have access by faith into this grace wherein we stand, and rejoice in hope of the glory of God.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And not only so, but we glory in tribulations also: knowing that tribulation worketh patience;</i></p> <p>4 <i>And patience, experience; and experience, hope:</i></p> <p>5 <i>And hope maketh not ashamed; because the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts by the Holy Ghost which is given unto us.</i></p> | <p>Through Him we have also obtained access by faith into this grace in which we stand, and we rejoice in hope of the glory of God.</p> <p>Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering produces endurance,</p> <p>and endurance produces character, and character produces hope.</p> <p>This hope does not disappoint us, because the love of God has been poured into our hearts through the Holy Ghost Who has been given to us.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" here is the old English word for "spirit" — the same divine Person that modern translations call the Holy Spirit.*

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| <p>6 <i>For when we were yet without strength, in due time Christ died for the ungodly.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For scarcely for a righteous man will one die: yet peradventure for a good man some would even dare to die.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Much more then, being now justified by his blood, we shall be saved from wrath through him.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For if, when we were enemies, we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more, being reconciled, we shall be saved by his life.</i></p> | <p>While we were still weak, at the right time Christ died for the ungodly.</p> <p>Rarely will anyone die for a righteous man, though perhaps for a good man someone might dare to die.</p> <p>But God shows His love for us in this: while we were still sinners, Christ died for us.</p> <p>Since we have now been justified by His blood, how much more shall we be saved from God's wrath through Him!</p> <p>If, while we were God's enemies, we were reconciled to Him through the death of His Son, how much more, having been reconciled, shall we be saved through His life!</p> |
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| <p>11 <i>And not only so, but we also joy in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom we have now received the atonement.</i></p> | <p>Not only that, but we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received the atonement.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Atonement** (ah-TONE-ment) — *the payment for sin that brings God and man back together. Christ's death on the cross was the atoning sacrifice — it satisfied God's justice and restored the broken relationship between God and man.*

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| <p>12 <i>Wherefore, as by one man sin entered into the world, and death by sin; and so death passed upon all men, for that all have sinned:</i></p> | <p>Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man and death through sin, so death spread to all men, because all sinned.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>(For until the law sin was in the world: but sin is not imputed when there is no law.</i></p> | <p>Sin was in the world before the law was given, but sin is not counted against someone when there is no law.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>Nevertheless death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over them that had not sinned after the similitude of Adam's transgression, who is the figure of him that was to come.</i></p> | <p>Yet death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over those who did not sin after the similitude of Adam's transgression, who was a figure of the One to come.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>But not as the offence, so also is the free gift. For if through the offence of one many be dead, much more the grace of God, and the gift by grace, which is by one man, Jesus Christ, hath abounded unto many.</i></p> | <p>But the free gift is not like the transgression. For if many died through one man's sin, how much more has the grace of God and the gift that came by the grace of the one man, Jesus Christ, overflowed to the many!</p> |
| <p>16 <i>And not as it was by one that sinned, so is the gift: for the judgment was by one to condemnation, but the free gift is of many offences unto justification.</i></p> | <p>The gift is not like the result of one man's sin. The judgment following one sin brought condemnation, but the free gift following many transgressions brought justification.</p> |

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| <p>17 <i>For if by one man's offence death reigned by one; much more they which receive abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness shall reign in life by one, Jesus Christ.)</i></p> <p>18 <i>Therefore as by the offence of one judgment came upon all men to condemnation; even so by the righteousness of one the free gift came upon all men unto justification of life.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Moreover the law entered, that the offence might abound. But where sin abounded, grace did much more abound:</i></p> <p>21 <i>That as sin hath reigned unto death, even so might grace reign through righteousness unto eternal life by Jesus Christ our Lord.</i></p> | <p>If, because of one man's sin, death reigned through that one man, how much more will those who receive the abundance of grace and the free gift of righteousness reign in life through the one man, Jesus Christ!</p> <p>Just as one trespass led to condemnation for all men, so one act of righteousness leads to justification and life for all men.</p> <p>Just as through the disobedience of one man the many were made sinners, so through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous.</p> <p>The law came in so that the transgression would increase. But where sin increased, grace increased all the more,</p> <p>so that, just as sin reigned in death, so also grace might reign through righteousness leading to eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Cross-References:

v1 — Isa 32:17; John 16:33; Rom 15:13; Col 1:20; Acts 13:38-39

v2 — Eph 2:18; Eph 3:12; Rom 12:12; 1 Cor 15:1; 1 Pet 3:18

v3 — Jas 1:2-3; Jas 1:12; 1 Pet 3:14; 2 Cor 12:9-10; 2 Cor 4:17

v4 — 1 Pet 5:10; Jas 1:12; 2 Cor 4:8-12; 2 Tim 4:16-18; Ps 71:18-24

v5 — Gal 4:6; Eph 3:16-19; Phil 1:20; 2 Tim 1:12; 2 Cor 1:22
v6 — Eph 2:1-5; Rom 5:8; Col 2:13; Titus 3:3-5; Rom 5:10
v8 — John 15:13; John 3:16; Rom 5:6; 1 Pet 3:18; 1 John 3:16
v9 — 1 Thess 1:10; Rom 8:1; Eph 2:13; Rom 3:24-26; John 5:24
v10 — 2 Cor 5:18-19; 2 Cor 4:10-11; Rom 8:32; Col 1:20-21; Rev 1:18
v12 — 1 Cor 15:21-22; Rom 5:19; Rom 6:23; Rom 3:23; Jas 1:15
v17 — 1 Cor 15:21-22; 1 Cor 15:49; Rom 5:12; John 10:10; 2 Tim 2:12
v19 — Rom 5:18; 2 Cor 5:21; Phil 2:8; Rom 5:12; Eph 1:6

Chapter 6

Paul argues that believers who have been baptized into Christ's death must not continue in sin, because they have died to sin and are alive to God. He instructs them to yield their members as instruments of righteousness, for sin shall not have dominion over those who are under grace, not the law.

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| 1 | <i>What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound?</i> | What shall we say then? Should we go on sinning so that grace may increase? |
| 2 | <i>God forbid. How shall we, that are dead to sin, live any longer therein?</i> | Not at all! We who died to sin — how can we live in it any longer? |
| 3 | <i>Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death?</i> | Do You not know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into His death? |
| 4 | <i>Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life.</i> | We were therefore buried with Him through baptism into death, so that, just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life. |
| 5 | <i>For if we have been planted together in the likeness of his death, we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection:</i> | If we have been united with Him in a death like His, we will certainly also be united with Him in a resurrection like His. |
| 6 | <i>Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him, that the body of sin might be destroyed, that henceforth we should not serve sin.</i> | We know that our old self was crucified with Him so that the body of sin might be destroyed, and we might no longer be slaves to sin. |

- 7 *For he that is dead is freed from sin.* For one who has died has been set free from sin.
- 8 *Now if we be dead with Christ, we believe that we shall also live with him:* Now if we have died with Christ, we believe we will also live with Him.
- 9 *Knowing that Christ being raised from the dead dieth no more; death hath no more dominion over him.* We know that Christ, having been raised from the dead, will never die again. Death no longer has dominion over Him.
- 10 *For in that he died, he died unto sin once: but in that he liveth, he liveth unto God.* The death He died, He died to sin once for all. The life He lives, He lives to God.
- 11 *Likewise reckon ye also yourselves to be dead indeed unto sin, but alive unto God through Jesus Christ our Lord.* In the same way, count yourselves dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 12 *Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body, that ye should obey it in the lusts thereof.* Do not let sin reign in Your mortal body so that You obey its evil desires.
- 13 *Neither yield ye your members as instruments of unrighteousness unto sin: but yield yourselves unto God, as those that are alive from the dead, and your members as instruments of righteousness unto God.* Do not offer the members of Your body to sin as instruments of unrighteousness. Instead, offer yourselves to God as those who have been brought from death to life, and offer the members of Your body to Him as instruments of righteousness.
- 14 *For sin shall not have dominion over you: for ye are not under the law, but under grace.* Sin shall not have dominion over You, for You are not under the law but under grace.
- 15 *What then? shall we sin, because we are not under the law, but under grace? God forbid.* What then? Shall we sin because we are not under the law but under grace? Not at all!

- 16 *Know ye not, that to whom ye yield yourselves servants to obey, his servants ye are to whom ye obey; whether of sin unto death, or of obedience unto righteousness?* Do You not know that if You present yourselves to someone as obedient servants, you are the servants of the one You obey — whether of sin leading to death, or of obedience leading to righteousness?
- 17 *But God be thanked, that ye were the servants of sin, but ye have obeyed from the heart that form of doctrine which was delivered you.* But thanks be to God that, though You were once servants of sin, You have wholeheartedly obeyed the pattern of teaching to which You were entrusted.
- 18 *Being then made free from sin, ye became the servants of righteousness.* Having been set free from sin, You have become servants of righteousness.
- 19 *I speak after the manner of men because of the infirmity of your flesh: for as ye have yielded your members servants to uncleanness and to iniquity unto iniquity; even so now yield your members servants to righteousness unto holiness.* I am speaking in human terms because of Your natural limitations. Just as You once offered Your members as servants to impurity and iniquity, leading to more iniquity — now offer them as servants to righteousness, leading to holiness.
- 20 *For when ye were the servants of sin, ye were free from righteousness.* When You were servants of sin, You were free from the control of righteousness.
- 21 *What fruit had ye then in those things whereof ye are now ashamed? for the end of those things is death.* What benefit did You gain from the things You are now ashamed of? The end of those things is death.
- 22 *But now being made free from sin, and become servants to God, ye have your fruit unto holiness, and the end everlasting life.* But now that You have been set free from sin and have become servants of God, the benefit You reap leads to holiness, and the end result is everlasting life.
- 23 *For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.* The wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Words in this chapter:

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

iniquity — Deep, twisted wrongdoing — stronger than 'sin'; the corruption beneath the sinful act, a bent toward evil.

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 2:16; Gal 5:13; Rom 6:15; Rom 2:4; Rom 3:5-8
- v2 — 1 John 3:9; Col 3:3; 1 Pet 2:24; Rom 7:4; Gal 2:19
- v3 — Gal 3:27; Gal 2:20-21; Rom 6:8; 1 Cor 12:13; Rom 6:4-5
- v4 — 2 Cor 5:17; Col 3:10; Eph 4:22-24; Rom 7:6; 1 Pet 3:21
- v6 — Gal 2:20; Gal 5:24; Eph 4:22; Gal 6:14; John 8:34-36
- v11 — Col 3:3-5; 1 Cor 6:20; Rom 6:2; Rom 6:13; Col 3:17
- v12 — Gal 5:16; Rom 6:16; Gal 5:24; 1 John 2:15-17; Rom 8:13
- v13 — Rom 12:1; Rom 6:16; 1 Pet 2:24; Col 3:5; 1 Cor 6:20
- v14 — Gal 5:18; Rom 8:2; Rom 7:4-11; Heb 8:10; Gal 4:4-5
- v16 — John 8:34; Matt 6:24; 2 Pet 2:19; Josh 24:15; Rom 6:12-13
- v22 — 1 Pet 2:16; Rom 6:18; Rom 8:2; Gal 5:13; John 8:32
- v23 — John 3:36; Rom 5:12; Jas 1:15; John 6:40; Ezek 18:20

Chapter 7

Paul explains that believers are dead to the law through the body of Christ, freed to serve in newness of spirit. He describes the inner struggle with sin: the law is holy and good, but sin dwelling in the flesh wages war against the mind, so that the good he would do he does not, and the evil he would not do he practices.

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| <p>1 <i>Know ye not, brethren, (for I speak to them that know the law,) how that the law hath dominion over a man as long as he liveth?</i></p> | <p>Do You not know, brothers — for I am speaking to those who know the law — that the law has authority over a person only as long as He lives?</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For the woman which hath an husband is bound by the law to her husband so long as he liveth; but if the husband be dead, she is loosed from the law of her husband.</i></p> | <p>A married woman is bound by law to her husband as long as He lives. But if her husband dies, she is released from the law of marriage.</p> |

- 3 *So then if, while her husband liveth, she be married to another man, she shall be called an adulteress: but if her husband be dead, she is free from that law; so that she is no adulteress, though she be married to another man.* So if she joins with another man while her husband is living, she will be called an adulteress. But if her husband dies, she is free from that law and is not an adulteress if she marries another man.
- 4 *Wherefore, my brethren, ye also are become dead to the law by the body of Christ; that ye should be married to another, even to him who is raised from the dead, that we should bring forth fruit unto God.* Likewise, my brothers, You also have died to the law through the body of Christ, so that You may belong to another — to Him who was raised from the dead — that we might bear fruit for God.
- 5 *For when we were in the flesh, the motions of sins, which were by the law, did work in our members to bring forth fruit unto death.* When we were in the flesh, the sinful passions aroused by the law were at work in our members to bear fruit for death.
- 6 *But now we are delivered from the law, that being dead wherein we were held; that we should serve in newness of spirit, and not in the oldness of the letter.* But now we have been released from the law, having died to that which held us captive, so that we serve in the new way of the Spirit and not in the old way of the written code.
- 7 *What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid. Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law: for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet.* What shall we say then? Is the law sin? Not at all! I would not have known sin except through the law. I would not have known what it was to covet if the law had not said, "You shall not covet."
- 8 *But sin, taking occasion by the commandment, wrought in me all manner of concupiscence. For without the law sin was dead.* But sin, seizing its opportunity through the commandment, produced in me every kind of covetousness. Apart from the law, sin is dead.
- 9 *For I was alive without the law once: but when the commandment came, sin revived, and I died.* I was once alive apart from the law, but when the commandment came, sin sprang to life and I died.

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| 10 <i>And the commandment, which was ordained to life, I found to be unto death.</i> | The very commandment that was meant to bring life proved to bring death to me. |
| 11 <i>For sin, taking occasion by the commandment, deceived me, and by it slew me.</i> | Sin, seizing the opportunity through the commandment, deceived me and through it killed me. |
| 12 <i>Wherefore the law is holy, and the commandment holy, and just, and good.</i> | So the law is holy, and the commandment is holy, righteous, and good. |
| 13 <i>Was then that which is good made death unto me? God forbid. But sin, that it might appear sin, working death in me by that which is good; that sin by the commandment might become exceeding sinful.</i> | Did that which is good, then, bring death to me? Not at all! It was sin, producing death in me through what is good, so that sin might be shown to be sin, and through the commandment might become extremely sinful. |
| 14 <i>For we know that the law is spiritual: but I am carnal, sold under sin.</i> | We know that the law is spiritual. But I am fleshly, sold under sin. |
| 15 <i>For that which I do I allow not: for what I would, that do I not; but what I hate, that do I.</i> | I do not understand what I am doing. I do not do what I want to do, but I do what I hate. |
| 16 <i>If then I do that which I would not, I consent unto the law that it is good.</i> | If I do what I do not want to do, I agree that the law is good. |
| 17 <i>Now then it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.</i> | So it is no longer I who do it, but sin that lives in me. |
| 18 <i>For I know that in me (that is, in my flesh,) dwelleth no good thing: for to will is present with me; but how to perform that which is good I find not.</i> | I know that nothing good lives in me — that is, in my flesh. The desire to do good is present in me, but I cannot carry it out. |
| 19 <i>For the good that I would I do not: but the evil which I would not, that I do.</i> | I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do — I keep on doing it. |
| 20 <i>Now if I do that I would not, it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.</i> | If I do what I do not want to do, it is no longer I who do it, but sin living in me that does it. |

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| <p>21 <i>I find then a law, that, when I would do good, evil is present with me.</i></p> <p>22 <i>For I delight in the law of God after the inward man:</i></p> <p>23 <i>But I see another law in my members, warring against the law of my mind, and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin which is in my members.</i></p> <p>24 <i>O wretched man that I am! who shall deliver me from the body of this death?</i></p> <p>25 <i>I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord. So then with the mind I myself serve the law of God; but with the flesh the law of sin.</i></p> | <p>So I find this law at work: whenever I want to do good, evil is right there with me.</p> <p>I delight in the law of God in my inner being,</p> <p>but I see another law at work in my members, waging war against the law of my mind and taking me captive to the law of sin that is at work in my members.</p> <p>What a wretched man I am! Who will deliver me from this body of death?</p> <p>Thanks be to God — through Jesus Christ our Lord! So then, with my mind I myself serve the law of God, but with my flesh I serve the law of sin.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

concupiscence (*kon-KYOO-pih-sense*) — sinful desire; the inward craving to do what God forbids

carnal (*KAR-nul*) — of the flesh; sold under sin — the condition of human nature apart from the Spirit

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rom 6:14; Rom 7:6; Rom 6:3; Prov 6:23; Rom 10:1
v2 — Gen 2:23-24; 1 Cor 7:4; 1 Cor 7:39; Num 30:7-8
v3 — Ex 20:14; Matt 5:32; Mark 10:6-12
v4 — 1 Pet 2:24; Gal 5:22-23; Isa 54:5; Rom 8:2; Eph 5:23-27
v6 — Gal 3:23-25; 2 Cor 3:6; Rom 7:4; Rom 6:4; Gal 2:19-20
v7 — Rom 3:20; Rom 4:15; 1 Cor 15:56; Ex 20:17; Deut 5:21
v12 — 1 Tim 1:8; Ps 119:137; Ps 19:7-12; Rom 7:14; Ps 119:172
v15 — Gal 5:17; Rom 7:19-20; Eccl 7:20; Nah 1:7; Jas 3:2
v18 — John 3:6; Ps 51:5; Gal 5:17; Rom 7:25; Ps 119:115-117
v22 — Ps 1:2; Ps 40:8; Ps 119:35; Ps 119:47-48; Heb 8:10
v23 — Gal 5:17; Jas 4:1; Rom 8:2; Rom 6:19; Rom 7:25
v24 — Rom 6:6; 2 Tim 4:18; Titus 2:14; Rom 8:2; Rom 8:26

Chapter 8

Paul declares that there is no condemnation for those in Christ Jesus who walk after the Spirit, and that the Spirit Himself bears witness with our spirit that we are the children of God. He argues that all things work together for good to those who love God, and that nothing — neither death, nor life, nor any creature — shall be able to separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus.

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| <p>1 <i>There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.</i></p> | <p>There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus, Who do not walk according to the flesh but according to the Spirit.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.</i></p> | <p>For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has set me free from the law of sin and death.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh:</i></p> | <p>For what the law could not do, because it was weakened by the flesh, God did by sending His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and as an offering for sin. He condemned sin in the flesh,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.</i></p> | <p>so that the righteous requirement of the law might be fulfilled in us, who do not walk according to the flesh but according to the Spirit.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh; but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit.</i></p> | <p>Those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh. Those who live according to the Spirit set their minds on the things of the Spirit.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace.</i></p> | <p>The mind set on the flesh is death, but the mind set on the Spirit is life and peace.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be.</i></p> | <p>The mind set on the flesh is hostile to God — it does not submit to God's law, nor can it do so.</p> |

- 8 *So then they that are in the flesh cannot please God.* Those who are in the flesh cannot please God.
- 9 *But ye are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you. Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of his.* You, however, are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if indeed the Spirit of God lives in You. But if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, He does not belong to Him.
- 10 *And if Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.* But if Christ is in You, then even though the body is dead because of sin, the Spirit gives life because of righteousness.
- 11 *But if the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit that dwelleth in you.* If the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead lives in You, He who raised Christ from the dead will also quicken Your mortal bodies through His Spirit who lives in You.
- 12 *Therefore, brethren, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh.* So then, brothers, we are not obligated to the flesh, to live according to the flesh.
- 13 *For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.* For if You live according to the flesh, You will die. But if by the Spirit You put to death the deeds of the body, You will live.
- 14 *For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.* For all who are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God.
- 15 *For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.* You have not received a spirit of slavery to fall back into fear. You have received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, "Abba, Father."
- 16 *The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God:* The Spirit Himself bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God.

- 17 *And if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ; if so be that we suffer with him, that we may be also glorified together.* If we are children, then we are heirs — heirs of God and fellow heirs with Christ — if indeed we suffer with Him so that we may also be glorified with Him.
- 18 *For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us.* I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worth comparing to the glory that will be revealed in us.
- 19 *For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God.* For the eager longing of creation waits for the revealing of the sons of God.
- 20 *For the creature was made subject to vanity, not willingly, but by reason of him who hath subjected the same in hope,* For the creation was subjected to frustration — not by its own choice but by the will of the One who subjected it — in hope
- 21 *Because the creature itself also shall be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God.* that the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and brought into the glorious freedom of the children of God.
- 22 *For we know that the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now.* We know that the whole creation has been groaning together in the pains of childbirth up to the present time.
- 23 *And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption, to wit, the redemption of our body.* Not only that, but we ourselves, who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for adoption — the redemption of our bodies.
- 24 *For we are saved by hope: but hope that is seen is not hope: for what a man seeth, why doth he yet hope for?* We are saved in hope. But hope that is seen is not hope — who hopes for what He already sees?
- 25 *But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it.* But if we hope for what we do not see, we wait for it with patience.

- 26 *Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought: but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.* Likewise the Spirit helps us in our weakness. We do not know what we should pray for as we ought, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groanings too deep for words.
- 27 *And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit, because he maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.* He who searches the hearts knows what the Spirit's mind is, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will of God.
- 28 *And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.* We know that all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are called according to His purpose.
- 29 *For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brethren.* Those He foreknew He also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son, so that He might be the firstborn among many brothers.
- 30 *Moreover whom he did predestinate, them he also called: and whom he called, them he also justified: and whom he justified, them he also glorified.* Those He predestined He also called; those He called He also justified; those He justified He also glorified.
- 31 *What shall we then say to these things? If God be for us, who can be against us?* What shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us?
- 32 *He that spared not his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how shall he not with him also freely give us all things?* He who did not spare his own Son but delivered him up for us all — will He not also, along with Him, freely give us all things?
- 33 *Who shall lay any thing to the charge of God's elect? It is God that justifieth.* Who will bring any charge against God's elect? It is God Who justifies.

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| <p>34 <i>Who is he that condemneth? It is Christ that died, yea rather, that is risen again, who is even at the right hand of God, who also maketh intercession for us.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword?</i></p> <p>36 <i>As it is written, For thy sake we are killed all the day long; we are accounted as sheep for the slaughter.</i></p> <p>37 <i>Nay, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him that loved us.</i></p> <p>38 <i>For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come,</i></p> <p>39 <i>Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.</i></p> | <p>Who is He that condemns? It is Christ Who died — more than that, who was raised to life — who is at the right hand of God and is also interceding for us.</p> <p>Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or danger, or sword?</p> <p>As it is written: "For Your sake we are being killed all day long. We are counted as sheep to be slaughtered."</p> <p>No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us.</p> <p>I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither things present nor things to come,</p> <p>neither height nor depth, nor any other created thing, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Abba (AB-ah) — Aramaic word for 'Father' — an intimate address to God, showing the believer's adoption as God's child.

wit — To know — 'to wit' means 'that is to say' or 'namely'; 'wot ye not' means 'don't you know?'

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

v1 — John 3:18-19; 2 Cor 5:17; Gal 3:13; Rom 5:1; 1 Cor 1:30

v2 — Rom 6:14; 2 Cor 3:17; Rom 6:18; 2 Cor 3:6; Rom 8:10-11

v6 — Gal 6:8; Rom 8:7; Rom 8:13; Rom 13:14; Rom 6:23

v11 — 2 Cor 4:14; Rom 6:4-5; 2 Cor 4:11; Eph 1:19-20; Rom 8:9
v14 — Gal 5:18; John 1:12; Gal 3:26; Gal 5:16; Ps 143:10
v18 — 2 Cor 4:17-18; 1 Pet 4:13; 1 Pet 1:5-7; Matt 5:11-12; Acts 20:24
v26 — Matt 10:20; Eph 6:18; Gal 4:6; John 14:16; Jude 1:20-21
v28 — 1 Pet 5:10; Jas 1:12; Gen 50:20; Rom 5:3-5; 1 Cor 2:9
v29 — Eph 1:4-5; Jer 1:5; Eph 1:11; 2 Tim 1:9; 1 Pet 1:20
v31 — Ps 118:6; Jer 1:19; Ps 56:11; 1 John 4:4; Isa 54:17
v32 — John 3:16; Rom 8:28; Ps 84:11; 1 John 4:10; 2 Cor 5:21
v37 — 1 Cor 15:57; 1 John 4:4; 2 Cor 2:14; 1 John 5:4-5; Rev 21:7

Chapter 9

Paul expresses great sorrow for Israel and argues that God's word has not failed, because not all who are of Israel are truly Israel. He defends God's sovereign right to show mercy on whom He will and to harden whom He will, as the potter has power over the clay.

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| 1 | <i>I say the truth in Christ, I lie not, my conscience also bearing me witness in the Holy Ghost,</i> | I am speaking the truth in Christ — I am not lying; my conscience confirms it in the Holy Ghost— |
| 2 | <i>That I have great heaviness and continual sorrow in my heart.</i> | that I have great sorrow and unceasing anguish in my heart. |
| 3 | <i>For I could wish that myself were accursed from Christ for my brethren, my kinsmen according to the flesh:</i> | I could wish that I myself were cursed and cut off from Christ for the sake of my brothers, my kinsmen according to the flesh. |
| 4 | <i>Who are Israelites; to whom pertaineth the adoption, and the glory, and the covenants, and the giving of the law, and the service of God, and the promises;</i> | They are Israelites. To them belong the adoption, the glory, the covenants, the giving of the law, the worship, and the promises. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenants** (KUV-en-ents) — *binding agreements; God's solemn promises that establish His relationship with His people. The covenants with Abraham, Moses, and David all pointed forward to the new covenant in Christ's blood.*

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| 5 | <i>Whose are the fathers, and of whom as concerning the flesh Christ came, who is over all, God blessed for ever. Amen.</i> | Theirs are the patriarchs, and from them, according to the flesh, came Christ, Who is God over all, blessed forever. Amen. |
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- 6 *Not as though the word of God hath taken none effect. For they are not all Israel, which are of Israel:* It is not as though God's word has failed. Not all who are descended from Israel are Israel.
- 7 *Neither, because they are the seed of Abraham, are they all children: but, In Isaac shall thy seed be called.* Not all of Abraham's children are his true descendants, but "Through Isaac your seed will be named."
- 8 *That is, They which are the children of the flesh, these are not the children of God: but the children of the promise are counted for the seed.* This means it is not the children of the flesh who are God's children, but the children of the promise who are counted as the seed.
- 9 *For this is the word of promise, At this time will I come, and Sara shall have a son.* For this is the word of promise: "At this time I will come, and Sarah shall have a son."
- 10 *And not only this; but when Rebecca also had conceived by one, even by our father Isaac;* Not only that, but when Rebecca had conceived children by one man — our forefather Isaac—
- 11 *(For the children being not yet born, neither having done any good or evil, that the purpose of God according to election might stand, not of works, but of him that calleth;)* before the twins were born and had done anything good or bad — so that God's purpose in election would stand, not by works but by His call—
- 12 *It was said unto her, The elder shall serve the younger.* she was told: "The older will serve the younger."
- 13 *As it is written, Jacob have I loved, but Esau have I hated.* As it is written: "Jacob I loved, but Esau I hated."
- 14 *What shall we say then? Is there unrighteousness with God? God forbid.* What shall we say then? Is there injustice with God? Not at all!
- 15 *For he saith to Moses, I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I will have compassion.* For He says to Moses: "I will have mercy on whom I have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I have compassion."

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| 16 <i>So then it is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that sheweth mercy.</i> | So then, it does not depend on human will or effort, but on God Who shows mercy. |
| 17 <i>For the scripture saith unto Pharaoh, Even for this same purpose have I raised thee up, that I might shew my power in thee, and that my name might be declared throughout all the earth.</i> | The scripture says to Pharaoh: "I raised you up for this very purpose — to display My power in you, so that My name might be proclaimed throughout all the earth." |
| 18 <i>Therefore hath he mercy on whom he will have mercy, and whom he will he hardeneth.</i> | So then, He has mercy on whom He will, and He hardens whom He will. |
| 19 <i>Thou wilt say then unto me, Why doth he yet find fault? For who hath resisted his will?</i> | You will say to me then, "Why does He still find fault? For who can resist His will?" |
| 20 <i>Nay but, O man, who art thou that repliest against God? Shall the thing formed say to him that formed it, Why hast thou made me thus?</i> | But who are you, O man, to argue with God? Will what is molded say to the one who molds it, "Why have you made me like this?" |
| 21 <i>Hath not the potter power over the clay, of the same lump to make one vessel unto honour, and another unto dishonour?</i> | Does not the potter have authority over the clay, to make from the same lump one vessel for honored use and another for common use? |
| 22 <i>What if God, willing to shew his wrath, and to make his power known, endured with much longsuffering the vessels of wrath fitted to destruction:</i> | What if God, wanting to show His wrath and make His power known, bore with great longsuffering the vessels of wrath prepared for destruction— |
| 23 <i>And that he might make known the riches of his glory on the vessels of mercy, which he had afore prepared unto glory,</i> | in order to make known the riches of His glory on vessels of mercy, which He had prepared beforehand for glory— |

- 24 *Even us, whom he hath called, not of the Jews only, but also of the Gentiles?* even us whom He has called, not from the Jews only but also from the Gentiles?
- 25 *As he saith also in Osee, I will call them my people, which were not my people; and her beloved, which was not beloved.* As He says in Hosea: "Those who were not My people I will call My people, and her who was not beloved I will call beloved."
- 26 *And it shall come to pass, that in the place where it was said unto them, Ye are not my people; there shall they be called the children of the living God.* "In the very place where it was said to them, 'You are not My people,' there they will be called children of the living God."
- 27 *Esaias also crieth concerning Israel, Though the number of the children of Israel be as the sand of the sea, a remnant shall be saved:* Isaiah cries out concerning Israel: "Though the number of the children of Israel be as the sand of the sea, only a remnant will be saved."
- 28 *For he will finish the work, and cut it short in righteousness: because a short work will the Lord make upon the earth.* "For the Lord will carry out His sentence on the earth completely and without delay."
- 29 *And as Esaias said before, Except the Lord of Sabaoth had left us a seed, we had been as Sodoma, and been made like unto Gomorrha.* As Isaiah said previously: "If the Lord of Sabaoth had not left us a seed, we would have become like Sodom and been made like Gomorrah."
- 30 *What shall we say then? That the Gentiles, which followed not after righteousness, have attained to righteousness, even the righteousness which is of faith.* What shall we say then? That Gentiles who did not pursue righteousness have attained it — the righteousness that is by faith.
- 31 *But Israel, which followed after the law of righteousness, hath not attained to the law of righteousness.* But Israel, who pursued a law of righteousness, has not attained it.

- 32 *Wherefore? Because they sought it not by faith, but as it were by the works of the law. For they stumbled at that stumblingstone;* Why not? Because they pursued it not by faith but as if it were by works. They stumbled over the stumbling stone,
- 33 *As it is written, Behold, I lay in Sion a stumblingstone and rock of offence: and whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.* as it is written: "See, I am laying in Zion a stone that causes stumbling and a rock of offense. Whoever believes in him will not be put to shame."

Words in this chapter:

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Hosea (*ho-ZAY-ah*) — A prophet whose marriage to an unfaithful wife illustrated Israel's unfaithfulness to God — his name means 'salvation.'

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Jacob (*JAY-kub*) — Isaac's second son — father of the twelve tribes of Israel; God later renamed him Israel ('one who wrestles with God'); his name means 'he grasps the heel.'

Gomorrah (*guh-MOR-ah*) — A city destroyed alongside Sodom — both cities became proverbial for divine judgment on extreme sin.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v5 — John 10:30; John 1:1-3; Col 1:16-19; Rom 1:25; 1 John 5:20

v6 — Gal 6:16; Rom 2:28-29; Rom 11:1-2; Rom 4:12-16; Rom 3:3

v9 — Gen 18:10; Gen 18:14; Gen 17:21; Gen 21:2; Heb 11:11-12

v15 — Ex 33:19; Rom 9:16; Mic 7:18; Rom 9:18-19; Ex 34:6-7

v16 — Eph 2:8; Phil 2:13; Matt 11:25-26; Eph 2:4-5; 1 Pet 2:9-10

v17 — Ex 9:16; Prov 16:4; Ex 14:17-18; Ex 10:1-2; Isa 37:20

v20 — Isa 29:16; Isa 45:9-11; Isa 64:8; Job 33:13; Job 40:2

v21 — Isa 64:8; Prov 16:4; 2 Tim 2:20-21; Jer 18:3-6; Acts 9:15

v22 — Prov 16:4; Jude 1:4; Rom 9:21; 1 Pet 2:8; 2 Tim 2:20

v25 — Hos 2:23; 1 Pet 2:10; Ezek 16:8; John 16:27

v27 — Isa 10:20-23; Rom 11:4-6; Isa 1:9; Hos 1:10; Jer 5:10

v33 — Isa 28:16; Isa 8:14-15; Rom 10:11; Joel 2:26-27; Ps 118:22

Chapter 10

Paul declares that Israel has a zeal for God but not according to knowledge, seeking to establish their own righteousness rather than submitting to the righteousness of God. He proclaims that whoever calls on the name of the Lord shall be saved, and that faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.

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| 1 <i>Brethren, my heart's desire and prayer to God for Israel is, that they might be saved.</i> | Brothers, my heart's desire and prayer to God for Israel is that they might be saved. |
| 2 <i>For I bear them record that they have a zeal of God, but not according to knowledge.</i> | I testify on their behalf that they have a zeal for God, but not according to knowledge. |
| 3 <i>For they being ignorant of God's righteousness, and going about to establish their own righteousness, have not submitted themselves unto the righteousness of God.</i> | For being ignorant of God's righteousness and seeking to establish their own righteousness, they have not submitted to God's righteousness. |
| 4 <i>For Christ is the end of the law for righteousness to every one that believeth.</i> | Christ is the end of the law for righteousness to everyone who believes. |
| 5 <i>For Moses describeth the righteousness which is of the law, That the man which doeth those things shall live by them.</i> | Moses writes about the righteousness that is based on the law: "The person who does these things will live by them." |
| 6 <i>But the righteousness which is of faith speaketh on this wise, Say not in thine heart, Who shall ascend into heaven? (that is, to bring Christ down from above:)</i> | But the righteousness based on faith says: "Do not say in Your heart, 'Who will ascend into heaven?'" — that is, to bring Christ down— |
| 7 <i>Or, Who shall descend into the deep? (that is, to bring up Christ again from the dead.)</i> | or "Who will descend into the deep?" — that is, to bring Christ up from the dead. |

- 8 *But what saith it? The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart: that is, the word of faith, which we preach;* But what does it say? "The word is near You, in Your mouth and in Your heart" — that is, the word of faith that we preach.
- 9 *That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.* If You confess with Your mouth that Jesus is Lord and believe in Your heart that God raised Him from the dead, You will be saved.
- 10 *For with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.* With the heart one believes and is justified, and with the mouth one confesses and is saved.
- 11 *For the scripture saith, Whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.* The scripture says: "Whosoever believes in him will not be put to shame."
- 12 *For there is no difference between the Jew and the Greek: for the same Lord over all is rich unto all that call upon him.* There is no distinction between Jew and Greek, for the same Lord is Lord of all and bestows His riches on all who call on Him.
- 13 *For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved.* "For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved."
- 14 *How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher?* How then shall they call on Him in whom they have not believed? How shall they believe in Him of whom they have not heard? How shall they hear without someone preaching?
- 15 *And how shall they preach, except they be sent? as it is written, How beautiful are the feet of them that preach the gospel of peace, and bring glad tidings of good things!* How shall they preach unless they are sent? As it is written: "How beautiful are the feet of those who preach the gospel of peace, who bring glad tidings of good things!"
- 16 *But they have not all obeyed the gospel. For Esaias saith, Lord, who hath believed our report?* But not all have obeyed the gospel. For Isaiah says: "Lord, who has believed our message?"

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| 17 | <i>So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.</i> | So then faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God. |
| 18 | <i>But I say, Have they not heard? Yes verily, their sound went into all the earth, and their words unto the ends of the world.</i> | But I ask: Have they not heard? Yes, certainly: "Their voice has gone out to all the earth, and their words to the ends of the world." |
| 19 | <i>But I say, Did not Israel know? First Moses saith, I will provoke you to jealousy by them that are no people, and by a foolish nation I will anger you.</i> | But I ask: Did not Israel know? First, Moses says: "I will provoke you to jealousy by those who are not a nation. By a foolish nation I will make you angry." |
| 20 | <i>But Esaias is very bold, and saith, I was found of them that sought me not; I was made manifest unto them that asked not after me.</i> | Then Isaiah boldly says: "I was found by those who did not seek Me. I revealed Myself to those who did not ask for Me." |
| 21 | <i>But to Israel he saith, All day long I have stretched forth my hands unto a disobedient and gainsaying people.</i> | But to Israel He says: "All day long I have held out My hands to a disobedient and argumentative people." |

Words in this chapter:

Isaiah (*eye-ZAY-ah*) — The greatest of the writing prophets — prophesied Judah's punishment and Israel's future salvation; wrote about the Messiah in remarkable detail; his name means 'the LORD is salvation.'

Cross-References:

- v4 — Gal 3:24; Rom 8:3-4; Matt 5:17-18; Acts 13:38-39; John 1:17
- v5 — Lev 18:5; Ezek 20:11; Neh 9:29; Ezek 20:21; Ezek 20:13
- v8 — Deut 30:14; Rom 1:16-17; 1 Tim 4:6; 1 Pet 1:25; Gal 3:2
- v9 — Luke 12:8; Acts 16:31; Phil 2:11; Matt 10:32-33; 1 John 4:2-3
- v10 — 1 John 4:15; Rom 10:9; Gal 2:16; John 1:12-13; John 3:19-21
- v11 — Isa 28:16; Rom 9:33; 1 Pet 2:6; Isa 49:23; Jer 17:7
- v12 — Phil 4:19; Rev 17:14; Gal 3:28; Rom 3:22; Ps 86:5
- v13 — Joel 2:32; Acts 2:21
- v14 — Mark 16:15-16; Acts 26:17-18; Titus 1:3; Acts 8:31; Heb 11:6
- v15 — Isa 52:7; Nah 1:15; Eph 2:17; Matt 28:18-20; Eph 6:15
- v17 — Gal 3:2; Gal 3:5; Luke 11:28; Col 3:16; 1 Thess 2:13
- v20 — Isa 65:1-2; Rom 9:30; Isa 55:4-5; Matt 22:9-10; Isa 49:6

Chapter 11

Paul argues that God has not cast away Israel, for a remnant according to the election of grace remains. He uses the olive tree to illustrate how Gentile branches were grafted in and warns them not to boast, declaring that blindness in part has happened to Israel until the fulness of the Gentiles comes in, and so all Israel shall be saved.

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| 1 <i>I say then, Hath God cast away his people? God forbid. For I also am an Israelite, of the seed of Abraham, of the tribe of Benjamin.</i> | I ask then: has God rejected his people? Not at all! I myself am an Israelite, a descendant of Abraham, from the tribe of Benjamin. |
| 2 <i>God hath not cast away his people which he foreknew. Wot ye not what the scripture saith of Elias? how he maketh intercession to God against Israel, saying,</i> | God has not rejected His people whom He foreknew. Do you not know what the scripture says about Elijah — how he pleaded with God against Israel? |
| 3 <i>Lord, they have killed thy prophets, and digged down thine altars; and I am left alone, and they seek my life.</i> | "Lord, they have killed Your prophets and torn down Your altars. I am the only one left, and they are trying to kill me." |
| 4 <i>But what saith the answer of God unto him? I have reserved to myself seven thousand men, who have not bowed the knee to the image of Baal.</i> | But what was God's answer to Him? "I have reserved for Myself seven thousand men who have not bowed the knee to Baal." |
| 5 <i>Even so then at this present time also there is a remnant according to the election of grace.</i> | So too, at the present time, there is a remnant chosen by grace. |
| 6 <i>And if by grace, then is it no more of works: otherwise grace is no more grace. But if it be of works, then is it no more grace: otherwise work is no more work.</i> | And if it is by grace, it is no longer by works — otherwise grace would no longer be grace. |
| 7 <i>What then? Israel hath not obtained that which he seeketh for; but the election hath obtained it, and the rest were blinded</i> | What then? What Israel was seeking, it did not obtain, but the elect did obtain it. The others were hardened, |

- 8 *(According as it is written, God hath given them the spirit of slumber, eyes that they should not see, and ears that they should not hear;) unto this day.* as it is written: "God gave them a spirit of stupor, eyes that would not see and ears that would not hear, to this very day."
- 9 *And David saith, Let their table be made a snare, and a trap, and a stumblingblock, and a recompence unto them:* David says: "Let their table become a snare and a trap, a stumbling block and a retribution to them."
- 10 *Let their eyes be darkened, that they may not see, and bow down their back always.* Let their eyes be darkened so they cannot see, and make their backs bend forever."
- 11 *I say then, Have they stumbled that they should fall? God forbid: but rather through their fall salvation is come unto the Gentiles, for to provoke them to jealousy.* I ask then: did they stumble so as to fall beyond recovery? Not at all! Rather, through their transgression, salvation has come to the Gentiles, to make Israel jealous.
- 12 *Now if the fall of them be the riches of the world, and the diminishing of them the riches of the Gentiles; how much more their fulness?* Now if their transgression brings riches to the world, and their failure brings riches to the Gentiles, how much more will their fullness bring!
- 13 *For I speak to you Gentiles, inasmuch as I am the apostle of the Gentiles, I magnify mine office:* I am speaking to you Gentiles. Since I am the apostle to the Gentiles, I make the most of my ministry,
- 14 *If by any means I may provoke to emulation them which are my flesh, and might save some of them.* in the hope that I may somehow arouse my own people to jealousy and save some of them.
- 15 *For if the casting away of them be the reconciling of the world, what shall the receiving of them be, but life from the dead?* For if their rejection brought reconciliation to the world, what will their acceptance be but life from the dead?
- 16 *For if the firstfruit be holy, the lump is also holy: and if the root be holy, so are the branches.* If the firstfruits are holy, the whole batch is holy. If the root is holy, so are the branches.

- 17 *And if some of the branches be broken off, and thou, being a wild olive tree, wert grafted in among them, and with them partakest of the root and fatness of the olive tree;* If some of the branches were broken off, and you — a wild olive shoot — were grafted in among them to share in the richness of the olive root,
- 18 *Boast not against the branches. But if thou boast, thou bearest not the root, but the root thee.* do not boast over those branches. If you do boast, remember that it is not you who supports the root, but the root that supports you.
- 19 *Thou wilt say then, The branches were broken off, that I might be grafted in.* You will say then, "Branches were broken off so that I could be grafted in."
- 20 *Well; because of unbelief they were broken off, and thou standest by faith. Be not highminded, but fear:* True. They were broken off because of unbelief, and you stand by faith. Do not be arrogant, but be afraid.
- 21 *For if God spared not the natural branches, take heed lest he also spare not thee.* For if God did not spare the natural branches, He will not spare you either.
- 22 *Behold therefore the goodness and severity of God: on them which fell, severity; but toward thee, goodness, if thou continue in his goodness: otherwise thou also shalt be cut off.* Consider therefore the goodness and severity of God — severity toward those who fell, but goodness toward you, if you continue in His goodness. Otherwise you too will be cut off.
- 23 *And they also, if they abide not still in unbelief, shall be grafted in: for God is able to graft them in again.* And if they do not persist in unbelief, they will be grafted in, for God is able to graft them in again.
- 24 *For if thou wert cut out of the olive tree which is wild by nature, and wert grafted contrary to nature into a good olive tree: how much more shall these, which be the natural branches, be grafted into their own olive tree?* After all, if you were cut from what is by nature a wild olive tree and grafted, contrary to nature, into a cultivated olive tree, how much more easily will these natural branches be grafted back into their own olive tree!

- 25 *For I would not, brethren, that ye should be ignorant of this mystery, lest ye should be wise in your own conceits; that blindness in part is happened to Israel, until the fulness of the Gentiles be come in.* I do not want you to be unaware of this mystery, brothers, so that you may not be conceited: a partial hardening has come upon Israel until the fullness of the Gentiles has come in.
- 26 *And so all Israel shall be saved: as it is written, There shall come out of Zion the Deliverer, and shall turn away ungodliness from Jacob:* Then all Israel will be saved, as it is written: "The Deliverer will come from Zion. He will turn godlessness away from Jacob.
- 27 *For this is my covenant unto them, when I shall take away their sins.* This is My covenant with them when I take away their sins."
- 28 *As concerning the gospel, they are enemies for your sakes: but as touching the election, they are beloved for the fathers' sakes.* As regards the gospel, they are enemies for your sake. But as regards election, they are beloved for the sake of the patriarchs.
- 29 *For the gifts and calling of God are without repentance.* For the gifts and the calling of God are without repentance.
- 30 *For as ye in times past have not believed God, yet have now obtained mercy through their unbelief:* Just as you were once disobedient to God but have now received mercy because of their disobedience,
- 31 *Even so have these also now not believed, that through your mercy they also may obtain mercy.* so they too have now been disobedient in order that, by the mercy shown to you, they also may now receive mercy.
- 32 *For God hath concluded them all in unbelief, that he might have mercy upon all.* For God has confined all men in disobedience so that He may show mercy to all.
- 33 *O the depth of the riches both of the wisdom and knowledge of God! how unsearchable are his judgments, and his ways past finding out!* Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are His judgments, and how inscrutable His ways!
- 34 *For who hath known the mind of the Lord? or who hath been his counsellor?* "For who has known the mind of the Lord? Or who has been His adviser?"

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| 35 | <i>Or who hath first given to him, and it shall be recompensed unto him again?</i> | "Or who has given a gift to Him that He should be repaid?" |
| 36 | <i>For of him, and through him, and to him, are all things: to whom be glory for ever. Amen.</i> | For from Him and through Him and to Him are all things. To Him be the glory forever. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 11:22; 1 Sam 12:22; Jer 33:24-26; Phil 3:5; Acts 26:4
v6 — Gal 2:21; 2 Tim 1:9; Rom 4:4-5; Titus 3:5; Rom 3:27-28
v8 — Deut 29:4; Isa 29:10; Ezek 12:2; 2 Cor 3:14-15; Jer 5:21
v17 — Eph 3:6; Eph 2:11-13; Matt 21:43; John 15:2; Jer 11:16
v22 — Heb 3:14; 1 Cor 15:2; Heb 3:6; John 15:2; Rev 2:5
v25 — Luke 21:24; 2 Cor 3:14-16; Rom 16:25; Rom 12:16; Zech 14:9-21
v26 — Isa 59:20; Jer 31:31-37; Ps 14:7; Zech 10:6-12; Hos 3:5
v27 — Jer 31:31-34; Isa 59:21; Jer 32:38-40; Isa 27:9; Ezek 36:25-29
v29 — Heb 7:21; Num 23:19; Mal 3:6; Rom 8:28; Hos 13:14
v33 — Job 11:7-9; Job 5:9; Ps 92:5; Col 2:2-3; Rom 2:4
v34 — Isa 40:13; 1 Cor 2:16; Job 15:8; Job 36:22; Jer 23:18
v36 — Col 1:15-17; 1 Cor 8:6; Heb 2:10; 1 Tim 1:17; Rom 16:27

Chapter 12

Paul urges believers to present their bodies as a living sacrifice and to be transformed by the renewing of their minds. He instructs them on the use of spiritual gifts within the body of Christ and on practical duties: love without hypocrisy, patience in tribulation, hospitality, and overcoming evil with good.

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| <p>1 <i>I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.</i></p> | <p>I urge You, brothers, by the mercies of God, to present Your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and acceptable to God — which is Your reasonable service.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.</i></p> | <p>Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of Your mind, so that You may discern what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.</i></p> | <p>By the grace given to me, I say to every one of you: do not think of yourself more highly than You ought, but think with sober judgment, each according to the measure of faith God has given You.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:</i></p> | <p>Just as we have many members in one body and these members do not all have the same function,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.</i></p> | <p>so we who are many are one body in Christ, and individually members of one another.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, whether prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith;</i></p> | <p>We have different gifts according to the grace given to us. If prophecy — use it in proportion to Your faith.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Or ministry, let us wait on our ministering; or he that teacheth, on teaching;</i></p> | <p>If serving — serve. If teaching — teach.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.</i></p> | <p>If encouraging — encourage. If giving — give generously. If leading — lead with diligence. If showing mercy — do it cheerfully.</p> |

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| 9 | <i>Let love be without dissimulation. Abhor that which is evil; cleave to that which is good.</i> | Let love be sincere. Hate what is evil; hold fast to what is good. |
| 10 | <i>Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another;</i> | Love one another with brotherly affection. In honor, put others before yourselves. |
| 11 | <i>Not slothful in business; fervent in spirit; serving the Lord;</i> | Do not be lazy, but be fervent in spirit. Serve the Lord. |
| 12 | <i>Rejoicing in hope; patient in tribulation; continuing instant in prayer;</i> | Rejoice in hope, be patient in tribulation, and be constant in prayer. |
| 13 | <i>Distributing to the necessity of saints; given to hospitality.</i> | Share with the Lord's people who are in need. Practice hospitality. |
| 14 | <i>Bless them which persecute you: bless, and curse not.</i> | Bless those who persecute You — bless and do not curse. |
| 15 | <i>Rejoice with them that do rejoice, and weep with them that weep.</i> | Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep. |
| 16 | <i>Be of the same mind one toward another. Mind not high things, but condescend to men of low estate. Be not wise in your own conceits.</i> | Live in harmony with one another. Do not be proud, but be willing to associate with people of low position. Do not be conceited. |
| 17 | <i>Recompense to no man evil for evil. Provide things honest in the sight of all men.</i> | Do not repay anyone evil for evil. Do what is right in the eyes of everyone. |
| 18 | <i>If it be possible, as much as lieth in you, live peaceably with all men.</i> | If it is possible, as far as it depends on You, live at peace with everyone. |
| 19 | <i>Dearly beloved, avenge not yourselves, but rather give place unto wrath: for it is written, Vengeance is mine; I will repay, saith the Lord.</i> | Do not take revenge, my dear friends, but leave room for God's wrath. "Vengeance is Mine; I will repay, says the Lord." |
| 20 | <i>Therefore if thine enemy hunger, feed him; if he thirst, give him drink: for in so doing thou shalt heap coals of fire on his head.</i> | "If Your enemy is hungry, feed Him. If He is thirsty, give Him a drink. In doing so, You will heap burning coals on His head." |

- 21

Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.
- Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good.

Words in this chapter:

- faith** — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.
- grace** — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.
- mercy** — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Pet 2:5; Rom 6:13; Heb 13:15-16; Rom 6:19; Eph 4:1
- v2** — 1 Pet 1:14; Eph 4:22-24; 2 Cor 5:17; Col 3:10; 1 John 2:15-17
- v3** — Gal 6:3; Phil 2:3-8; Prov 26:12; 1 Pet 5:5; Rom 12:16
- v9** — Ps 34:14; 1 Pet 4:8; 1 Tim 1:5; 1 John 3:18-20; 1 Pet 3:10-11
- v10** — Phil 2:3; John 13:34-35; Heb 13:1; 1 John 4:11; 1 Pet 3:8-9
- v11** — Heb 6:10-11; Acts 18:25; Rev 3:15-16; Prov 13:4; Col 3:22-24
- v12** — Rom 15:13; Heb 10:36; Ps 62:8; Rom 5:2-4; Phil 4:6-7
- v15** — 1 Cor 12:26; Heb 13:3; Ps 35:13-14; John 11:33-36; Job 30:25
- v18** — Heb 12:14; Matt 5:9; Rom 14:19; 2 Cor 13:11; Jas 3:16-18
- v19** — Deut 32:35; Heb 10:30; Prov 24:29; Prov 20:22; Rom 12:17
- v20** — Prov 25:21-22; Matt 5:44; Luke 6:27; Ex 23:4-5; 2 Kgs 6:22
- v21** — 1 Pet 3:9; Luke 6:27-30; Prov 16:32

Chapter 13

Paul instructs believers to submit to governing authorities, for the powers that be are ordained of God, and whoever resists the authority resists the ordinance of God. He summarizes the law in the command to love one's neighbor and urges the church to put on the armour of light, for salvation is nearer than when they first believed.

- 1

Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God: the powers that be are ordained of God.
- Let every person be subject to the governing authorities, for there is no authority except from God, and those that exist have been established by God.
- 2

Whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God: and they that resist shall receive to themselves damnation.
- Therefore whoever resists the authority resists what God has ordained, and those who resist will bring damnation on themselves.

- 3 *For rulers are not a terror to good works, but to the evil. Wilt thou then not be afraid of the power? do that which is good, and thou shalt have praise of the same:* For rulers are not a terror to good conduct, but to bad. Do you want to be free from fear of the one in authority? Do what is good and you will have his approval.
- 4 *For he is the minister of God to thee for good. But if thou do that which is evil, be afraid; for he beareth not the sword in vain: for he is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil.* For he is God's servant for your good. But if you do wrong, be afraid — He does not carry the sword for nothing. He is God's servant, an agent of wrath to bring punishment on the wrongdoer.
- 5 *Wherefore ye must needs be subject, not only for wrath, but also for conscience sake.* Therefore it is necessary to be in submission, not only to avoid God's wrath but also for the sake of conscience.
- 6 *For for this cause pay ye tribute also: for they are God's ministers, attending continually upon this very thing.* This is also why you pay taxes, for the authorities are God's servants, devoting themselves to this very thing.
- 7 *Render therefore to all their dues: tribute to whom tribute is due; custom to whom custom; fear to whom fear; honour to whom honour.* Pay to all what is owed to them: taxes to whom taxes are owed, revenue to whom revenue is owed, respect to whom respect is owed, honor to whom honor is owed.
- 8 *Owe no man any thing, but to love one another: for he that loveth another hath fulfilled the law.* Owe no one anything except to love one another, for the one who loves another has fulfilled the law.
- 9 *For this, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not kill, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness, Thou shalt not covet; and if there be any other commandment, it is briefly comprehended in this saying, namely, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.* The commandments — you shall not commit adultery, you shall not kill, you shall not steal, you shall not bear false witness, you shall not covet — and any other commandment are summed up in this one rule: "Love your neighbor as yourself."

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| <p>10 <i>Love worketh no ill to his neighbour: therefore love is the fulfilling of the law.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And that, knowing the time, that now it is high time to awake out of sleep: for now is our salvation nearer than when we believed.</i></p> <p>12 <i>The night is far spent, the day is at hand: let us therefore cast off the works of darkness, and let us put on the armour of light.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Let us walk honestly, as in the day; not in rioting and drunkenness, not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But put ye on the Lord Jesus Christ, and make not provision for the flesh, to fulfil the lusts thereof.</i></p> | <p>Love does no harm to a neighbor. Therefore love is the fulfillment of the law.</p> <p>Do this, knowing the time — that the hour has come for you to wake from sleep, for our salvation is nearer now than when we first believed.</p> <p>The night is almost over; the day is near. So let us put aside the deeds of darkness and put on the armor of light.</p> <p>Let us behave properly, as in the daytime — not in carousing and drunkenness, not in sexual immorality and sensuality, not in strife and jealousy.</p> <p>Instead, clothe yourselves with the Lord Jesus Christ, and make no plans to gratify the desires of the flesh.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Titus 3:1; 1 Pet 2:13-17; Dan 2:21; John 19:11; Prov 8:15-16
v2 — 1 Pet 2:13; Titus 3:1; Jas 3:1; Rom 13:5; Luke 20:47
v3 — Eccl 10:4-6; Prov 14:35; 1 Pet 2:13-14; Prov 20:2; Deut 25:1
v6 — Matt 22:17-21; Luke 23:2; Luke 20:21-26; Mark 12:14-17; Matt 17:24-27
v7 — Prov 24:21; Luke 20:25; 1 Pet 2:17-18; Matt 17:25; Matt 22:21
v8 — Rom 13:10; Matt 22:39-40; Gal 5:14; Matt 7:12; Prov 3:27-28
v9 — Ex 20:12-17; Matt 22:39; Luke 10:27; Mark 12:31; Deut 5:16-21
v10 — Rom 13:8; Matt 22:39-40; 1 Cor 13:4-7
v11 — 1 Thess 5:5-8; 1 Pet 4:7; Eph 5:14; Mark 13:35-37; 1 Cor 15:34
v12 — Ezek 18:31-32; Eph 5:11; 2 Cor 6:7; Col 3:8-17; Eph 6:11-18
v13 — Gal 5:21; Eph 5:18; 1 Thess 4:3-5; 1 Pet 4:3-5; 1 Thess 4:12
v14 — Eph 4:24; Gal 5:16-17; Gal 3:27; 1 Pet 2:11; Gal 5:24

Chapter 14

Paul instructs believers to receive the weak in faith without passing judgment on disputable matters such as eating and observing days. He argues that every person shall give account of himself to God, and that the kingdom of God is not about food and drink but righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.

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| 1 | <i>Him that is weak in the faith receive ye, but not to doubtful disputations.</i> | Accept the one who is weak in faith, but do not quarrel over opinions. |
| 2 | <i>For one believeth that he may eat all things: another, who is weak, eateth herbs.</i> | One person believes He may eat anything, while the weak person eats only vegetables. |
| 3 | <i>Let not him that eateth despise him that eateth not; and let not him which eateth not judge him that eateth: for God hath received him.</i> | Let not the one who eats despise the one who does not, and let not the one who does not eat judge the one who does, for God has accepted Him. |
| 4 | <i>Who art thou that judgest another man's servant? to his own master he standeth or falleth. Yea, he shall be holden up: for God is able to make him stand.</i> | Who are You to judge someone else's servant? To his own master he stands or falls. And He will stand, for the Lord is able to make Him stand. |
| 5 | <i>One man esteemeth one day above another: another esteemeth every day alike. Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind.</i> | One person considers one day more sacred than another; another considers every day alike. Each one should be fully convinced in his own mind. |
| 6 | <i>He that regardeth the day, regardeth it unto the Lord; and he that regardeth not the day, to the Lord he doth not regard it. He that eateth, eateth to the Lord, for he giveth God thanks; and he that eateth not, to the Lord he eateth not, and giveth God thanks.</i> | Whoever observes the day, observes it to the Lord. Whoever eats, eats to the Lord, for he gives thanks to God. Whoever does not eat, abstains to the Lord and gives thanks to God. |
| 7 | <i>For none of us liveth to himself, and no man dieth to himself.</i> | For none of us lives to Himself, and none of us dies to Himself. |

- 8 *For whether we live, we live unto the Lord; and whether we die, we die unto the Lord: whether we live therefore, or die, we are the Lord's.* If we live, we live to the Lord; if we die, we die to the Lord. Whether we live or die, we belong to the Lord.
- 9 *For to this end Christ both died, and rose, and revived, that he might be Lord both of the dead and living.* For this very reason Christ died and came back to life — that He might be Lord of both the dead and the living.
- 10 *But why dost thou judge thy brother? or why dost thou set at nought thy brother? for we shall all stand before the judgment seat of Christ.* Why then do You judge Your brother? Or why do You look down on Your brother? For we will all stand before God's judgment seat.
- 11 *For it is written, As I live, saith the Lord, every knee shall bow to me, and every tongue shall confess to God.* As it is written: "As I live, says the Lord, every knee will bow to Me, and every tongue will confess to God."
- 12 *So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God.* So then, each of us will give an account of himself to God.
- 13 *Let us not therefore judge one another any more: but judge this rather, that no man put a stumblingblock or an occasion to fall in his brother's way.* Let us therefore stop judging one another. Instead, make up Your mind not to put a stumbling block or obstacle in Your brother's way.
- 14 *I know, and am persuaded by the Lord Jesus, that there is nothing unclean of itself: but to him that esteemeth any thing to be unclean, to him it is unclean.* I am convinced, as one who is in the Lord Jesus, that nothing is unclean in itself. But to the one who considers something to be unclean, to him it is unclean.
- 15 *But if thy brother be grieved with thy meat, now walkest thou not charitably. Destroy not him with thy meat, for whom Christ died.* If Your brother is grieved because of what You eat, You are no longer walking charitably. Do not destroy by Your food the one for whom Christ died.
- 16 *Let not then your good be evil spoken of:* Do not let what You consider good to be spoken of as evil.

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| <p>17 <i>For the kingdom of God is not meat and drink; but righteousness, and peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For he that in these things serveth Christ is acceptable to God, and approved of men.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Let us therefore follow after the things which make for peace, and things wherewith one may edify another.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For meat destroy not the work of God. All things indeed are pure; but it is evil for that man who eateth with offence.</i></p> <p>21 <i>It is good neither to eat flesh, nor to drink wine, nor any thing whereby thy brother stumbleth, or is offended, or is made weak.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Hast thou faith? have it to thyself before God. Happy is he that condemneth not himself in that thing which he alloweth.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And he that doubteth is damned if he eat, because he eateth not of faith: for whatsoever is not of faith is sin.</i></p> | <p>For the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating and drinking, but of righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.</p> <p>Whoever serves Christ in this way is pleasing to God and approved by men.</p> <p>So then, let us pursue what makes for peace and what builds one another up.</p> <p>Do not destroy the work of God for the sake of food. All food is clean, but it is wrong for anyone to eat in a way that causes someone else to stumble.</p> <p>It is better not to eat meat or drink wine or do anything else that will cause Your brother to stumble or be offended or made weak.</p> <p>The faith that You have, keep between Yourself and God. Blessed is the one who does not condemn himself by what he approves.</p> <p>But whoever doubts is damned if he eats, because the eating is not from faith — and everything that does not come from faith is sin.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rom 15:1; 1 Cor 8:7-13; 1 Cor 9:22; Rom 15:7; Rom 14:21

v3 — Rom 14:10; Col 2:16-17; Luke 18:9; 1 Cor 10:29-30; Rom 14:13

v4 — Jas 4:11-12; Rom 9:20; Rom 8:31-39; Jude 1:24; 1 Cor 4:4-5

v7 — 1 Pet 4:2; 2 Cor 5:15; 1 Cor 6:19-20; Titus 2:14; 1 Thess 5:10

v8 — Phil 1:20; 1 Thess 5:10; Acts 21:13; 1 Cor 15:23; Rev 14:13
v11 — Isa 45:22-25; Phil 2:10-11; Ps 72:11; Rom 10:9; Isa 49:18
v12 — Matt 12:36; 1 Pet 4:5; Matt 16:27; Gal 6:5; Eccl 11:9
v13 — 2 Cor 6:3; 1 Cor 8:9-13; Jas 4:11; Luke 17:2; Rom 16:17
v17 — Matt 6:33; Rom 15:13; 1 Cor 4:20; 1 Cor 8:8; Gal 5:22
v19 — Eph 4:29; Rom 12:18; Ps 34:14; Rom 15:2; Heb 12:14
v22 — 1 John 3:21; Rom 14:5; Jas 3:13; Gal 6:1; Rom 14:23
v23 — Heb 11:6; Titus 1:15; 1 Cor 8:7; 1 Cor 11:29-31; Rom 14:5

Chapter 15

Paul urges the strong to bear with the weak and to follow Christ's example of selflessness, declaring that Christ became a minister to the Jews and that the Gentiles might glorify God for His mercy. He shares his ambition to preach where Christ has not been named and outlines his plans to visit Rome on his way to Spain.

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| 1 | <i>We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves.</i> | We who are strong ought to bear with the failings of the weak and not to please ourselves. |
| 2 | <i>Let every one of us please his neighbour for his good to edification.</i> | Each of us should please his neighbor for his good, to build Him up. |
| 3 | <i>For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me.</i> | For even Christ did not please Himself, but as it is written: "The reproaches of those who reproached You fell on Me." |
| 4 | <i>For whatsoever things were written aforetime were written for our learning, that we through patience and comfort of the scriptures might have hope.</i> | For whatever was written in former days was written for our instruction, so that through the endurance and encouragement of the scriptures we might have hope. |
| 5 | <i>Now the God of patience and consolation grant you to be likeminded one toward another according to Christ Jesus:</i> | May the God of endurance and encouragement grant You to be of one mind with one another, in keeping with Christ Jesus, |
| 6 | <i>That ye may with one mind and one mouth glorify God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | so that together You may with one voice glorify the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. |

- 7 *Wherefore receive ye one another, as Christ also received us to the glory of God.* Therefore accept one another, just as Christ also accepted us, to the glory of God.
- 8 *Now I say that Jesus Christ was a minister of the circumcision for the truth of God, to confirm the promises made unto the fathers:* I tell You that Christ became a servant to the circumcised to show God's truthfulness — to confirm the promises given to the patriarchs—
- 9 *And that the Gentiles might glorify God for his mercy; as it is written, For this cause I will confess to thee among the Gentiles, and sing unto thy name.* and in order that the Gentiles might glorify God for His mercy. As it is written: "Therefore I will praise You among the Gentiles, and sing to Your name."
- 10 *And again he saith, Rejoice, ye Gentiles, with his people.* Again it says: "Rejoice, You Gentiles, together with His people."
- 11 *And again, Praise the Lord, all ye Gentiles; and laud him, all ye people.* And again: "Praise the Lord, all You Gentiles, and let all the peoples praise Him."
- 12 *And again, Esaias saith, There shall be a root of Jesse, and he that shall rise to reign over the Gentiles; in him shall the Gentiles trust.* And again Isaiah says: "The Root of Jesse will come — He who rises to rule the Gentiles. In him the Gentiles will hope."
- 13 *Now the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that ye may abound in hope, through the power of the Holy Ghost.* May the God of hope fill You with all joy and peace in believing, so that by the power of the Holy Ghost You may overflow with hope.
- 14 *And I myself also am persuaded of you, my brethren, that ye also are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish one another.* I myself am satisfied about You, my brothers, that You yourselves are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, and able to instruct one another.
- 15 *Nevertheless, brethren, I have written the more boldly unto you in some sort, as putting you in mind, because of the grace that is given to me of God,* But I have written to You rather boldly on some points, as a reminder to You, because of the grace God gave me

- 16 *That I should be the minister of Jesus Christ to the Gentiles, ministering the gospel of God, that the offering up of the Gentiles might be acceptable, being sanctified by the Holy Ghost.* to be a minister of Christ Jesus to the Gentiles, serving as a priest in the gospel of God, so that the offering of the Gentiles might be acceptable — sanctified by the Holy Ghost.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctified** (SANK-tih-fyde) — *made holy; set apart for God.*

Sanctification is the ongoing work of the Holy Ghost in the believer's life, making us more like Christ and setting us apart from the world.

- 17 *I have therefore whereof I may glory through Jesus Christ in those things which pertain to God.* I have reason to boast in Christ Jesus about the things that pertain to God.
- 18 *For I will not dare to speak of any of those things which Christ hath not wrought by me, to make the Gentiles obedient, by word and deed,* I will not venture to speak of anything except what Christ has accomplished through me to bring the Gentiles to obedience — by word and deed,
- 19 *Through mighty signs and wonders, by the power of the Spirit of God; so that from Jerusalem, and round about unto Illyricum, I have fully preached the gospel of Christ.* by the power of signs and wonders, by the power of the Spirit of God — so that from Jerusalem and all the way around to Illyricum I have fully proclaimed the gospel of Christ.
- 20 *Yea, so have I strived to preach the gospel, not where Christ was named, lest I should build upon another man's foundation:* Thus I make it my ambition to preach the gospel where Christ has not already been named, rather than building on someone else's foundation.
- 21 *But as it is written, To whom he was not spoken of, they shall see; and they that have not heard shall understand.* As it is written: "Those who have never been told about Him will see, and those who have never heard will understand."
- 22 *For which cause also I have been much hindered from coming to you.* This is why I have been so often hindered from coming to You.
- 23 *But now having no more place in these parts, and having a great desire these many years to come unto you;* But now, with no more room for work in these regions, and having longed for many years to come to You,

- 24 *Whensoever I take my journey into Spain, I will come to you: for I trust to see you in my journey, and to be brought on my way thitherward by you, if first I be somewhat filled with your company.* I hope to see You in passing as I travel to Spain. I hope to enjoy Your company for a while and then to have You assist me on my journey there.
- 25 *But now I go unto Jerusalem to minister unto the saints.* For now, I am going to Jerusalem to serve the saints.
- 26 *For it hath pleased them of Macedonia and Achaia to make a certain contribution for the poor saints which are at Jerusalem.* For Macedonia and Achaia were pleased to make a contribution for the poor among the saints in Jerusalem.
- 27 *It hath pleased them verily; and their debtors they are. For if the Gentiles have been made partakers of their spiritual things, their duty is also to minister unto them in carnal things.* They were pleased to do this, and indeed they owe it to them. For if the Gentiles have shared in the Jews' spiritual blessings, they owe it to the Jews to share with them their material blessings.
- 28 *When therefore I have performed this, and have sealed to them this fruit, I will come by you into Spain.* When I have completed this and have delivered this contribution securely to them, I will come to You on my way to Spain.
- 29 *And I am sure that, when I come unto you, I shall come in the fulness of the blessing of the gospel of Christ.* I know that when I come to You, I will come with the full blessing of the gospel of Christ.
- 30 *Now I beseech you, brethren, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, and for the love of the Spirit, that ye strive together with me in your prayers to God for me;* I urge You, brothers, by our Lord Jesus Christ and by the love of the Spirit, to join me in earnest prayer to God on my behalf.
- 31 *That I may be delivered from them that do not believe in Judaea; and that my service which I have for Jerusalem may be accepted of the saints;* Pray that I may be delivered from those in Judea who do not believe, and that my service for Jerusalem may be acceptable to the saints,

- 32

That I may come unto you with joy by the will of God, and may with you be refreshed.

so that by God's will I may come to You with joy and be refreshed together with You.
- 33

Now the God of peace be with you all. Amen.

May the God of peace be with you all. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Thess 5:14; Rom 14:1; Gal 6:1-2; 1 Cor 9:22; 1 Cor 12:22-24
- v2 — Rom 14:19; 1 Cor 10:24; Phil 2:4-5; 1 Cor 10:33-11:1; 1 Cor 9:19-22
- v3 — Ps 69:9; Phil 2:8; John 5:30; Ps 89:50-51; John 6:38
- v4 — 1 Cor 10:11; 2 Tim 3:16-17; Rom 4:23-24; 2 Pet 1:20-21; Heb 10:35-36
- v5 — Phil 2:4-5; Rom 15:13; 1 Pet 3:8; Rom 12:16; Eph 5:2
- v6 — John 10:29-30; Eph 1:3; Acts 4:24; Rev 1:6; 2 Cor 11:31
- v7 — Matt 10:40; John 13:34; Rom 14:1-3; Rom 5:2; Mark 9:37
- v8 — Gal 4:4-5; Matt 15:24; 2 Cor 1:20; John 1:11; Acts 3:25-26
- v9 — 2 Sam 22:50; Ps 18:49; Rom 3:29; Matt 9:8
- v12 — Isa 11:10; Isa 11:1; Rev 22:16; Matt 12:21; Rev 5:5
- v13 — 2 Thess 2:16-17; Rom 12:12; 2 Cor 9:8; Rom 14:17; Gal 5:22
- v21 — Isa 52:15; Isa 65:1

Chapter 16

Paul commends Phoebe to the church and greets many believers by name, including Priscilla and Aquila who risked their own necks for his life. He warns them to mark those who cause divisions contrary to the doctrine they have learned and closes with a doxology to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ.

- 1

I commend unto you Phebe our sister, which is a servant of the church which is at Cenchrea:

I commend to You our sister Phoebe, a servant of the church at Cenchrea.
- 2

That ye receive her in the Lord, as becometh saints, and that ye assist her in whatsoever business she hath need of you: for she hath been a succourer of many, and of myself also.

Receive her in the Lord in a way worthy of the saints, and help her with whatever she needs from You, for she has been a great help to many people, including me.

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| 3 | <i>Greet Priscilla and Aquila my helpers in Christ Jesus:</i> | Greet Priscilla and Aquila, my co-workers in Christ Jesus. |
| 4 | <i>Who have for my life laid down their own necks: unto whom not only I give thanks, but also all the churches of the Gentiles.</i> | They risked their own necks for my life, to whom not only I give thanks but also all the churches of the Gentiles. |
| 5 | <i>Likewise greet the church that is in their house. Salute my wellbeloved Epänetus, who is the firstfruits of Achaia unto Christ.</i> | Greet also the church that meets in their home. Greet my beloved Epänetus, who is the firstfruits of Achaia unto Christ. |
| 6 | <i>Greet Mary, who bestowed much labour on us.</i> | Greet Mary, who worked very hard for you. |
| 7 | <i>Salute Andronicus and Junia, my kinsmen, and my fellowprisoners, who are of note among the apostles, who also were in Christ before me.</i> | Greet Andronicus and Junia, my kinsmen and my fellow prisoners. They are well known among the apostles and were in Christ before me. |
| 8 | <i>Greet Amplias my beloved in the Lord.</i> | Greet Amplias, my beloved in the Lord. |
| 9 | <i>Salute Urbane, our helper in Christ, and Stachys my beloved.</i> | Greet Urbanus, our co-worker in Christ, and my beloved Stachys. |
| 10 | <i>Salute Apelles approved in Christ. Salute them which are of Aristobulus' household.</i> | Greet Apelles, who is approved in Christ. Greet those who belong to the household of Aristobulus. |
| 11 | <i>Salute Herodion my kinsman. Greet them that be of the household of Narcissus, which are in the Lord.</i> | Greet my kinsman Herodion. Greet those in the household of Narcissus who are in the Lord. |
| 12 | <i>Salute Tryphena and Tryphosa, who labour in the Lord. Salute the beloved Persis, which laboured much in the Lord.</i> | Greet Tryphena and Tryphosa, who work hard in the Lord. Greet the beloved Persis, who has worked very hard in the Lord. |
| 13 | <i>Salute Rufus chosen in the Lord, and his mother and mine.</i> | Greet Rufus, chosen in the Lord, and His mother, who has been a mother to me too. |

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| 14 <i>Salute Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermas, Patrobas, Hermes, and the brethren which are with them.</i> | Greet Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermas, Patrobas, Hermes, and the brothers with them. |
| 15 <i>Salute Philologus, and Julia, Nereus, and his sister, and Olympas, and all the saints which are with them.</i> | Greet Philologus, Julia, Nereus and His sister, and Olympas, and all the saints with them. |
| 16 <i>Salute one another with an holy kiss. The churches of Christ salute you.</i> | Greet one another with a holy kiss. All the churches of Christ greet You. |
| 17 <i>Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.</i> | I urge You, brothers, to watch out for those who cause divisions and create obstacles contrary to the teaching You have learned. Avoid them. |
| 18 <i>For they that are such serve not our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by good words and fair speeches deceive the hearts of the simple.</i> | For such people do not serve our Lord Jesus Christ but their own belly. By good words and fair speeches they deceive the hearts of the simple. |
| 19 <i>For your obedience is come abroad unto all men. I am glad therefore on your behalf: but yet I would have you wise unto that which is good, and simple concerning evil.</i> | Your obedience is known to all, and I rejoice over You. But I want You to be wise about what is good and innocent about what is evil. |
| 20 <i>And the God of peace shall bruise Satan under your feet shortly. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.</i> | The God of peace will soon crush Satan under your feet. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with You. |
| 21 <i>Timotheus my workfellow, and Lucius, and Jason, and Sosipater, my kinsmen, salute you.</i> | Timothy, my co-worker, greets you. So do Lucius, Jason, and Sosipater, my kinsmen. |
| 22 <i>I Tertius, who wrote this epistle, salute you in the Lord.</i> | I, Tertius, who wrote down this letter, greet you in the Lord. |

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| <p>23 <i>Gaius mine host, and of the whole church, saluteth you. Erastus the chamberlain of the city saluteth you, and Quartus a brother.</i></p> <p>24 <i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Now to him that is of power to stablish you according to my gospel, and the preaching of Jesus Christ, according to the revelation of the mystery, which was kept secret since the world began,</i></p> <p>26 <i>But now is made manifest, and by the scriptures of the prophets, according to the commandment of the everlasting God, made known to all nations for the obedience of faith:</i></p> <p>27 <i>To God only wise, be glory through Jesus Christ for ever. Amen.</i></p> | <p>Gaius, who is host to me and to the whole church, greets you. Erastus, the city treasurer, greets you, and so does our brother Quartus.</p> <p>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.</p> <p>Now to Him who is able to strengthen You according to my gospel and the preaching of Jesus Christ — according to the revelation of the mystery that was kept hidden for ages past—</p> <p>but is now disclosed and made known through the prophetic writings, by the command of the eternal God, to bring about obedience of faith among all nations—</p> <p>to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ, be glory forever. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Aquila (AK-wih-lah) — A Jewish tent-maker from Pontus who worked and traveled with Paul — expelled from Rome by Emperor Claudius; husband of Priscilla; his name means 'eagle.'

Priscilla (prih-SIL-ah) — Wife of Aquila, a tent-maker couple who hosted a church in their home — worked with Paul and taught Apollos; her name is a Latin diminutive of Prisca ('ancient').

Cross-References:

- v3 — Acts 18:26; 1 Cor 16:19; 2 Tim 4:19
- v5 — Col 4:15; 1 Cor 16:19; Phlm 1:2
- v10 — Rom 14:18; 1 Pet 1:7; Deut 8:2
- v16 — 1 Cor 16:20; 1 Thess 5:26; 2 Cor 13:12; 1 Pet 5:14
- v17 — Jude 1:19; 2 Thess 3:6; 1 Tim 6:3-5; 2 Tim 3:5; Col 2:8
- v18 — Col 2:4; Matt 7:15; 1 Tim 6:5; Mic 3:5; 2 Tim 3:2-6
- v19 — Matt 10:16; 1 Cor 14:20; Jas 3:13-18; Phil 2:15; Rom 1:8
- v20 — Luke 10:19; 1 John 3:8; Gen 3:15; Zech 10:5; Mal 4:3

v23 — 1 Cor 1:14; Acts 19:22

v25 — 1 Cor 2:7; Col 1:26-27; Rom 2:16; Eph 1:9; 2 Thess 2:14

v26 — Rom 15:18; Rom 1:5; Gal 3:8; Isa 40:28; 1 Tim 1:17

v27 — 1 Tim 1:17; Rom 11:36; Rev 7:10-12

1 Corinthians

Author: Paul the apostle, with Sosthenes named as co-sender (1:1); Paul founded the Corinthian church on his second missionary journey (Acts 18).

Date written: c. AD 54–55, from Ephesus during Paul's third missionary journey, in response to reports and questions from the Corinthian church.

Written to: The church at Corinth — a congregation in one of the most cosmopolitan and morally corrupt port cities in the Roman empire, plagued by factionalism, sexual immorality, and theological confusion.

Setting: Corinth was a city of extraordinary wealth, social diversity, and sexual license. The church reflected its environment — divided over personalities, tolerating open sin, misusing spiritual gifts, and confused about the resurrection. Paul writes to correct, instruct, and restore order.

Where this sits historically: Written from Ephesus during the early years of Nero's reign, while Gallio's earlier ruling at Corinth (Acts 18, c. AD 51) had established a legal precedent of Roman tolerance toward Paul's mission.

Contemporaries: Apollos, Cephas (Peter), Timothy, and Sosthenes were all active leaders in this same window, and Paul wrote this letter shortly before composing 2 Corinthians and Romans.

Big themes:

- The cross as the center — against Corinthian boasting in wisdom and eloquence, Paul insists that "Christ crucified" is the only message that has power to save
- Church unity — factionalism ("I am of Paul," "I am of Apollos") is rebuked; the church is one body with many members
- Holiness in a pagan city — sexual immorality, lawsuits between believers, and idol-food are all addressed with the reminder that believers are temples of the Holy Ghost
- Charity — chapter 13 defines the love that must govern every exercise of spiritual gifts; without it, everything is nothing
- The resurrection — chapter 15 is the NT's fullest treatment of Christ's bodily resurrection and the resurrection of believers; it is the foundation of the whole Christian faith

Key passages: 1 Cor 1:18; 6:19–20; 13:4–7; 15:3–4; 15:55–57

How it fits: 1 Corinthians is the most practical of Paul's major letters — it addresses nearly every disorder a congregation can face. Chapter 13 on charity and chapter 15 on the resurrection are among the most read passages in all of Scripture. It was written from Ephesus shortly before Romans.

Chapter 1

Paul rebukes the Corinthians for their divisions, as some claim to follow Paul, Apollos, Cephas, or Christ. He argues that the preaching of the cross is foolishness to those who perish but the power of God to those who are saved, and that God has chosen the foolish things of the world to shame the wise.

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| 1 <i>Paul, called to be an apostle of Jesus Christ through the will of God, and Sosthenes our brother,</i> | Paul, called by the will of God to be an apostle of Jesus Christ, and our brother Sosthenes, |
| 2 <i>Unto the church of God which is at Corinth, to them that are sanctified in Christ Jesus, called to be saints, with all that in every place call upon the name of Jesus Christ our Lord, both theirs and ours:</i> | To the church of God that is in Corinth — to those sanctified in Christ Jesus, called to be saints — together with all those who in every place call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, both their Lord and ours: |
| 3 <i>Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | Grace to You and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 4 <i>I thank my God always on your behalf, for the grace of God which is given you by Jesus Christ;</i> | I give thanks to my God always for You because of the grace of God that was given You in Christ Jesus. |
| 5 <i>That in every thing ye are enriched by him, in all utterance, and in all knowledge;</i> | In Him You were enriched in every way — in all speech and in all knowledge— |
| 6 <i>Even as the testimony of Christ was confirmed in you:</i> | because the testimony about Christ was confirmed in You. |
| 7 <i>So that ye come behind in no gift; waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ:</i> | You are not lacking in any spiritual gift as You wait for the revealing of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 8 <i>Who shall also confirm you unto the end, that ye may be blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | He will also keep You firm to the end, so that You will be blameless on the day of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 9 <i>God is faithful, by whom ye were called unto the fellowship of his Son Jesus Christ our Lord.</i> | God is faithful, by whom You were called into the fellowship of His Son, Jesus Christ our Lord. |

- 10 *Now I beseech you, brethren, by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye all speak the same thing, and that there be no divisions among you; but that ye be perfectly joined together in the same mind and in the same judgment.* I urge You, brothers, by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that all of You agree and that there be no divisions among You. Be united in the same mind and the same judgment.
- 11 *For it hath been declared unto me of you, my brethren, by them which are of the house of Chloe, that there are contentions among you.* It has been reported to me by Chloe's people that there are quarrels among You, my brothers.
- 12 *Now this I say, that every one of you saith, I am of Paul; and I of Apollos; and I of Cephas; and I of Christ.* What I mean is this: each of You says, "I follow Paul," or "I follow Apollos," or "I follow Cephas," or "I follow Christ."
- 13 *Is Christ divided? was Paul crucified for you? or were ye baptized in the name of Paul?* Is Christ divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Were you baptized in the name of Paul?
- 14 *I thank God that I baptized none of you, but Crispus and Gaius;* I am thankful that I baptized none of You except Crispus and Gaius,
- 15 *Lest any should say that I had baptized in mine own name.* so that no one can say you were baptized in my name.
- 16 *And I baptized also the household of Stephanas: besides, I know not whether I baptized any other.* I also baptized the household of Stephanas; beyond that, I do not know whether I baptized anyone else.
- 17 *For Christ sent me not to baptize, but to preach the gospel: not with wisdom of words, lest the cross of Christ should be made of none effect.* For Christ did not send me to baptize but to preach the gospel — not with wisdom of words, so that the cross of Christ might not be emptied of its power.
- 18 *For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God.* For the message of the cross is foolishness to them that perish, but to us who are saved it is the power of God.

- 19 *For it is written, I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and will bring to nothing the understanding of the prudent.* For it is written: "I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and I will set aside the understanding of the intelligent."
- 20 *Where is the wise? where is the scribe? where is the disputer of this world? hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world?* Where is the wise man? Where is the teacher of the law? Where is the debater of this age? Has not God made foolish the wisdom of the world?
- 21 *For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe.* For since in the wisdom of God the world through its wisdom did not know God, it pleased God through the foolishness of what is preached to save those who believe.
- 22 *For the Jews require a sign, and the Greeks seek after wisdom:* Jews demand signs and Greeks seek wisdom,
- 23 *But we preach Christ crucified, unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness;* but we preach Christ crucified — a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Gentiles,
- 24 *But unto them which are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God, and the wisdom of God.* but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ is the power of God and the wisdom of God.
- 25 *Because the foolishness of God is wiser than men; and the weakness of God is stronger than men.* For the foolishness of God is wiser than men, and the weakness of God is stronger than men.
- 26 *For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called:* Brothers, consider Your calling: not many of You were wise by human standards, not many were powerful, not many were of noble birth.
- 27 *But God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty;* But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise, and God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.

- 28

And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, yea, and things which are not, to bring to nought things that are:

God chose the lowly things of this world, the despised things — and the things that are not — to bring to nothing the things that are,
- 29

That no flesh should glory in his presence.

so that no one may boast before God.
- 30

But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:

It is because of Him that You are in Christ Jesus, Who has become for us wisdom from God — that is, our righteousness, sanctification, and redemption—

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctification** (*sank-tih-fih-KAY-shun*) — *being made holy; the lifelong process of being set apart for God. Justification is the one-time verdict of "not guilty." Sanctification is the ongoing work of God making us holy in our daily lives.*

- 31

That, according as it is written, He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord.

Therefore, as it is written: "Let the one who boasts, boast in the Lord."

Words in this chapter:

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

sanctification — Being made holy — the lifelong process of being set apart for God and growing to look more like Christ.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Apollos (*ah-POL-os*) — A learned Jewish Christian from Alexandria — eloquent in the Scriptures and mighty in argument; Priscilla and Aquila taught him a more accurate understanding of the faith.

Corinth (*KOR-inth*) — A major commercial city in southern Greece — Paul founded a church here on his second journey; the city's notorious immorality shaped many of Paul's letters.

Cross-References:

- v5** — 2 Cor 9:11; 2 Cor 8:7; Col 2:3; Phil 1:9; Rom 15:14
v8 — 1 Thess 5:23-24; 1 Thess 3:13; Col 1:22; Phil 1:6; Jude 1:24-25
v9 — 2 Thess 3:3; Heb 10:23; Deut 7:9; 1 John 1:3; 1 Cor 10:13
v10 — Phil 2:1-4; Eph 4:1-7; 1 Cor 12:25; Rom 12:16; Jas 3:13-18

v17 — 1 Cor 2:1; 1 Cor 2:13; 2 Pet 1:16; 1 Cor 2:4-5; 2 Cor 10:10
v18 — 1 Cor 2:14; Rom 1:16; 2 Thess 2:10; 1 Cor 1:23-25; 2 Cor 4:3
v19 — Isa 29:14; Jer 8:9; 1 Cor 3:19; Job 5:12-13; Isa 19:11
v23 — 1 Cor 2:14; 1 Pet 2:8; 1 Cor 2:2; Isa 8:14-15; Gal 5:11
v24 — 1 Cor 1:30; Col 2:3; 1 Cor 1:18; Rom 1:16; 1 Cor 1:9
v27 — Jas 2:5; Matt 11:25; 1 Cor 1:20; Ps 8:2; Luke 21:15
v30 — Eph 1:7; Phil 3:9; Rom 8:1; 1 Cor 1:2; Col 1:14
v31 — Jer 9:23-24; 2 Cor 10:17; Phil 3:3; Ps 105:3; Isa 41:16

Chapter 2

Paul recalls that he came to Corinth not with eloquent wisdom but in weakness, determined to know nothing except Jesus Christ and Him crucified. He teaches that the Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God, and that the natural man does not receive the things of the Spirit because they are spiritually discerned.

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| 1 | <i>And I, brethren, when I came to you, came not with excellency of speech or of wisdom, declaring unto you the testimony of God.</i> | When I came to You, brothers, I did not come with eloquence or human wisdom as I proclaimed to You the testimony of God. |
| 2 | <i>For I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ, and him crucified.</i> | I resolved to know nothing while I was with You except Jesus Christ and Him crucified. |
| 3 | <i>And I was with you in weakness, and in fear, and in much trembling.</i> | I came to You in weakness, in fear, and with great trembling. |
| 4 | <i>And my speech and my preaching was not with enticing words of man's wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power:</i> | My speech and my preaching were not with persuasive words of human wisdom, but with a demonstration of the Spirit and of power, |
| 5 | <i>That your faith should not stand in the wisdom of men, but in the power of God.</i> | so that Your faith might not rest on human wisdom but on the power of God. |
| 6 | <i>Howbeit we speak wisdom among them that are perfect: yet not the wisdom of this world, nor of the princes of this world, that come to nought:</i> | We do, however, speak wisdom among the mature. But it is not the wisdom of this age or of the rulers of this age, who are passing away. |

- 7 *But we speak the wisdom of God in a mystery, even the hidden wisdom, which God ordained before the world unto our glory:* We speak God's wisdom, a mystery that has been hidden — the wisdom God ordained before the ages for our glory.
- 8 *Which none of the princes of this world knew: for had they known it, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.* None of the rulers of this age knew it, for if they had known it, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.
- 9 *But as it is written, Eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither have entered into the heart of man, the things which God hath prepared for them that love him.* But as it is written: "No eye has seen, no ear has heard, no mind has conceived what God has prepared for those who love Him."
- 10 *But God hath revealed them unto us by his Spirit: for the Spirit searcheth all things, yea, the deep things of God.* But God has revealed it to us by His Spirit. The Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God.
- 11 *For what man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him? even so the things of God knoweth no man, but the Spirit of God.* For who knows a man's thoughts except the man's own spirit? In the same way, no one knows the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God.
- 12 *Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God.* We have not received the spirit of the world but the Spirit Who is from God, so that we may understand what God has freely given us.
- 13 *Which things also we speak, not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual.* We speak of these things not in words taught by human wisdom, but in words taught by the Holy Ghost, interpreting spiritual truths in spiritual words.
- 14 *But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him: neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.* The natural person does not accept the things of the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to Him. He cannot understand them because they are spiritually discerned.

15	<i>But he that is spiritual judgeth all things, yet he himself is judged of no man.</i>	The spiritual person judges all things, but He Himself is not subject to anyone's judgment.
16	<i>For who hath known the mind of the Lord, that he may instruct him? But we have the mind of Christ.</i>	"For who has known the mind of the Lord, that He may instruct Him?" But we have the mind of Christ.

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 1:17; 1 Cor 2:4; 1 Cor 2:13; Ex 4:10
- v2 — Gal 6:14; Phil 3:8-10; John 17:3; 1 Cor 1:22-25; Gal 3:1
- v4 — 1 Cor 4:20; 1 Thess 1:5; 1 Cor 1:17; 1 Cor 2:1; Rom 15:19
- v5 — 2 Cor 4:7; 2 Cor 12:9; 2 Cor 6:7; 1 Cor 1:17; 1 Cor 3:6
- v7 — Col 1:26-27; 2 Pet 1:3; Rom 16:25-26; Ps 78:2; Matt 11:25
- v9 — Isa 64:4; Ps 31:19; Jas 1:12; Rom 8:28; Isa 65:17
- v10 — John 14:26; Eph 3:5; Luke 10:21; John 16:13; Eph 3:3
- v11 — Prov 20:27; 1 Cor 2:10; Jer 17:9; Prov 14:10; Rom 11:33-34
- v12 — 1 John 2:27; Rom 8:5-6; 1 John 2:20; 1 John 5:19-20; 1 John 4:4-5
- v14 — 1 Cor 1:18; Rom 8:5-8; Matt 13:11-17; 2 Cor 4:4-6; 1 John 2:27
- v15 — 1 Thess 5:21; Heb 5:14; Prov 28:5; 1 John 4:1; 1 Cor 14:37
- v16 — Isa 40:13-14; Rom 11:34; John 16:13-16; John 15:15; Job 15:8

Chapter 3

Paul calls the Corinthians carnal because of their jealousy and strife, saying he planted and Apollos watered but God gave the increase. He warns that each man's work will be tested by fire, and that the temple of God is holy — for if any man destroys the temple of God, God will destroy him.

1	<i>And I, brethren, could not speak unto you as unto spiritual, but as unto carnal, even as unto babes in Christ.</i>	Brothers, I could not address You as spiritual people but as people of the flesh — as infants in Christ.
2	<i>I have fed you with milk, and not with meat: for hitherto ye were not able to bear it, neither yet now are ye able.</i>	I fed You with milk, not solid food, for You were not ready for it. Indeed, You are still not ready,

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| <p>3 <i>For ye are yet carnal: for whereas there is among you envying, and strife, and divisions, are ye not carnal, and walk as men?</i></p> <p>4 <i>For while one saith, I am of Paul; and another, I am of Apollos; are ye not carnal?</i></p> <p>5 <i>Who then is Paul, and who is Apollos, but ministers by whom ye believed, even as the Lord gave to every man?</i></p> <p>6 <i>I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.</i></p> <p>7 <i>So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.</i></p> <p>10 <i>According to the grace of God which is given unto me, as a wise masterbuilder, I have laid the foundation, and another buildeth thereon. But let every man take heed how he buildeth thereupon.</i></p> <p>11 <i>For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, which is Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Now if any man build upon this foundation gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, stubble;</i></p> | <p>for You are still of the flesh. For as long as there is jealousy and strife among You, are You not of the flesh and walking like mere men?</p> <p>For when someone says, "I follow Paul," and another, "I follow Apollos," are you not merely human?</p> <p>What then is Apollos? What is Paul? Servants through whom you believed, as the Lord assigned to each.</p> <p>I planted, Apollos watered, but God gave the growth.</p> <p>So neither he who plants nor he who waters is anything, but only God Who gives the growth.</p> <p>He who plants and he who waters are one, and each will receive his wages according to his labor.</p> <p>We are God's co-workers. You are God's field, God's building.</p> <p>By the grace God gave me, I laid a foundation as a skilled builder, and someone else is building on it. Each one must be careful how he builds.</p> <p>For no one can lay any other foundation than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ.</p> <p>Whether anyone builds on this foundation with gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, or straw—</p> |
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- 13 *Every man's work shall be made manifest: for the day shall declare it, because it shall be revealed by fire; and the fire shall try every man's work of what sort it is.* each one's work will become clear. The Day will bring it to light, because it will be revealed by fire, and the fire will test what kind of work each has done.
- 14 *If any man's work abide which he hath built thereupon, he shall receive a reward.* If what He has built survives, He will receive a reward.
- 15 *If any man's work shall be burned, he shall suffer loss: but he himself shall be saved; yet so as by fire.* If His work is burned up, He will suffer loss — though He Himself will be saved, but only as through fire.
- 16 *Know ye not that ye are the temple of God, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you?* Do You not know that You are God's temple and that God's Spirit lives in You?
- 17 *If any man defile the temple of God, him shall God destroy; for the temple of God is holy, which temple ye are.* If anyone destroys God's temple, God will destroy Him. For God's temple is holy, and You are that temple.
- 18 *Let no man deceive himself. If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become a fool, that he may be wise.* Let no one deceive himself. If anyone among you thinks he is wise in the ways of this age, He should become a fool so that He may become wise.
- 19 *For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God. For it is written, He taketh the wise in their own craftiness.* The wisdom of this world is foolishness in God's sight. As it is written: "He catches the wise in their own craftiness."
- 20 *And again, The Lord knoweth the thoughts of the wise, that they are vain.* And again: "The Lord knows the thoughts of the wise, that they are futile."
- 21 *Therefore let no man glory in men. For all things are yours;* So let no one boast in men. For all things belong to you —
- 22 *Whether Paul, or Apollos, or Cephas, or the world, or life, or death, or things present, or things to come; all are yours;* whether Paul or Apollos or Cephas or the world or life or death or the present or the future — all are yours,

- 23
- And ye are Christ's; and Christ is God's.*

and You are Christ's, and Christ is God's.

Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 5:13; 1 Cor 2:14-15; Eph 4:13-14; 1 Cor 14:20; 1 Cor 2:6
- v6 — 1 Cor 3:9-10; Prov 11:25; 2 Cor 10:14-15; 1 Cor 9:1; Acts 18:4-11
- v7 — John 15:5; Gal 6:3; 2 Cor 12:9; Ps 115:1; 1 Cor 13:2
- v9 — 1 Pet 2:5; Eph 2:20-22; 2 Cor 6:1; 1 Cor 3:16; Mark 16:20
- v10 — 1 Cor 3:11; Eph 2:20; Rom 15:20; Matt 24:45; Dan 12:3
- v11 — Eph 2:20; Isa 28:16; 2 Tim 2:19; Acts 4:11-12; 1 Pet 2:6-8
- v13 — 1 Pet 1:7; Rev 20:12; 1 Cor 3:14-15; 1 Cor 4:5; Zech 13:9
- v15 — 2 John 1:8; 1 Cor 3:12-13; Jude 1:23; Rev 3:18; 1 Pet 4:18
- v16 — 1 Cor 6:19; Ezek 36:27; 2 Cor 6:16; Rom 8:11; Eph 2:21-22
- v18 — Prov 3:5; 1 Cor 1:18-21; Isa 5:21; Gal 6:3; 1 Cor 8:1-2
- v19 — Job 5:13; Ps 141:10; 1 Cor 1:19-20; Rom 1:21-22; Isa 44:25
- v21 — Rom 8:32; Rom 8:28; Jer 9:23-24; 1 Cor 4:6; Rev 21:7

Chapter 4

Paul teaches that apostles are stewards of the mysteries of God and that it is the Lord who judges, so they should not judge before the time. He contrasts the Corinthians' pride with the apostles' suffering, and warns them as a father that he will come to them and test not their words but their power.

- 1

Let a man so account of us, as of the ministers of Christ, and stewards of the mysteries of God.

This is how one should regard us — as servants of Christ and stewards of the mysteries of God.
- 2

Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.

Now it is required of stewards that they be found faithful.
- 3

But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged of you, or of man's judgment: yea, I judge not mine own self.

With me it is a very small thing that I should be judged by You or by any human court. In fact, I do not even judge myself.

- 4 *For I know nothing by myself; yet am I not hereby justified: but he that judgeth me is the Lord.* I am not aware of anything against myself, but I am not acquitted by this. It is the Lord who judges me.
- 5 *Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord come, who both will bring to light the hidden things of darkness, and will make manifest the counsels of the hearts: and then shall every man have praise of God.* Therefore do not judge anything before the appointed time — wait until the Lord comes. He will bring to light what is hidden in darkness and will expose the motives of the heart. Then each person will receive His praise from God.
- 6 *And these things, brethren, I have in a figure transferred to myself and to Apollos for your sakes; that ye might learn in us not to think of men above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another.* I have applied these things to myself and Apollos for your benefit, brothers, so that you may learn from us the meaning of "not beyond what is written," so that none of You will be puffed up in favor of one against another.
- 7 *For who maketh thee to differ from another? and what hast thou that thou didst not receive? now if thou didst receive it, why dost thou glory, as if thou hadst not received it?* For who makes You different from anyone else? What do you have that you did not receive? If You received it, why do You boast as if You did not receive it?
- 8 *Now ye are full, now ye are rich, ye have reigned as kings without us: and I would to God ye did reign, that we also might reign with you.* Already You have all You want! Already You have become rich! Without us You have become kings! How I wish You really were kings, so that we might be kings with You!
- 9 *For I think that God hath set forth us the apostles last, as it were appointed to death: for we are made a spectacle unto the world, and to angels, and to men.* For I think that God has set forth us apostles last, as men appointed to death; for we are made a spectacle to the world, and to angels, and to men.

- 10 *We are fools for Christ's sake, but ye are wise in Christ; we are weak, but ye are strong; ye are honourable, but we are despised.* We are fools for Christ's sake, but You are so wise in Christ! We are weak, but You are strong! You are honored, but we are despised!
- 11 *Even unto this present hour we both hunger, and thirst, and are naked, and are buffeted, and have no certain dwellingplace;* To this very hour we go hungry and thirsty. We are poorly clothed, brutally treated, and have no settled home.
- 12 *And labour, working with our own hands: being reviled, we bless; being persecuted, we suffer it:* We work hard with our own hands. When we are cursed, we bless. When we are persecuted, we endure it.
- 13 *Being defamed, we intreat: we are made as the filth of the world, and are the offscouring of all things unto this day.* When we are slandered, we answer kindly. We have become the scum of the earth, the garbage of the world — right up to this moment.
- 14 *I write not these things to shame you, but as my beloved sons I warn you.* I am not writing this to shame You, but to warn You as my dear children.
- 15 *For though ye have ten thousand instructors in Christ, yet have ye not many fathers: for in Christ Jesus I have begotten you through the gospel.* Even if You had ten thousand guardians in Christ, You do not have many fathers, for in Christ Jesus I became Your father through the gospel.
- 16 *Wherefore I beseech you, be ye followers of me.* I urge You, then, be imitators of me.
- 17 *For this cause have I sent unto you Timotheus, who is my beloved son, and faithful in the Lord, who shall bring you into remembrance of my ways which be in Christ, as I teach every where in every church.* That is why I sent You Timothy, who is my beloved and faithful child in the Lord. He will remind You of my ways in Christ, as I teach them everywhere in every church.
- 18 *Now some are puffed up, as though I would not come to you.* Some of You have become arrogant, as though I were not coming to You.

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| <p>19 <i>But I will come to you shortly, if the Lord will, and will know, not the speech of them which are puffed up, but the power.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For the kingdom of God is not in word, but in power.</i></p> <p>21 <i>What will ye? shall I come unto you with a rod, or in love, and in the spirit of meekness?</i></p> | <p>But I will come to You soon, if the Lord wills, and I will find out not the talk of these arrogant people but their power.</p> <p>For the kingdom of God is not in words but in power.</p> <p>What do You prefer? Shall I come to You with a rod, or in love with a gentle spirit?</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Apollos (*ah-POL-os*) — A learned Jewish Christian from Alexandria — eloquent in the Scriptures and mighty in argument; Priscilla and Aquila taught him a more accurate understanding of the faith.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Pet 4:10; 1 Tim 3:9; Titus 1:7; Eph 6:19; 2 Cor 4:5
v2 — Matt 25:21; Luke 12:42; Luke 16:10-12; Prov 13:17; Col 4:17
v4 — Ps 143:2; 1 John 3:20-21; Ps 130:3; 2 Cor 1:12; Ps 19:12
v5 — Jas 5:7; 2 Cor 5:10; 1 Cor 3:13; Heb 4:13; 2 Cor 10:18
v6 — 2 Cor 11:4; 2 Cor 12:19; 2 Cor 12:6; Rom 12:3; Col 2:18
v7 — John 3:27; Jas 1:17; 1 Pet 4:10; 1 Chr 29:11-16; Rom 12:6
v10 — 1 Cor 2:3; 1 Cor 3:18; Acts 26:24; 2 Cor 13:9; Acts 17:18
v11 — Rom 8:35; 2 Cor 11:23-27; Phil 4:12; 2 Tim 3:11; Matt 8:20
v12 — 1 Pet 3:9; Matt 5:11; Rom 12:14; 1 Pet 4:12-14; Luke 6:28
v16 — Phil 3:17; 2 Thess 3:9; 1 Cor 11:1; 1 Thess 1:6; Heb 13:7
v17 — 1 Tim 1:2; 1 Cor 16:10; 1 Cor 7:17; 2 Tim 1:2; 1 Cor 16:1
v20 — 1 Cor 2:4; 1 Thess 1:5; 2 Cor 10:4-5; Rom 14:17; Rom 1:16

Chapter 5

Paul rebukes the church for tolerating a man living in fornication with his father's wife and commands them to deliver him to Satan for the destruction of the flesh so that his spirit may be saved. He instructs them to purge out the old leaven, for Christ our passover is sacrificed for us, and not to keep company with any so-called brother living in open sin.

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| 1 <i>It is reported commonly that there is fornication among you, and such fornication as is not so much as named among the Gentiles, that one should have his father's wife.</i> | It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among You — and of a kind that even unbelievers do not tolerate: a man is sleeping with his father's wife. |
| 2 <i>And ye are puffed up, and have not rather mourned, that he that hath done this deed might be taken away from among you.</i> | And You are proud! Should You not rather have mourned? The one who did this should be removed from your midst. |
| 3 <i>For I verily, as absent in body, but present in spirit, have judged already, as though I were present, concerning him that hath so done this deed,</i> | Even though I am absent in body, I am present with You in spirit. And I have already passed judgment on the one who did this, just as if I were present. |
| 4 <i>In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when ye are gathered together, and my spirit, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,</i> | When You are assembled in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ and my spirit is present, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ, |
| 5 <i>To deliver such an one unto Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.</i> | hand this man over to Satan for the destruction of his flesh, so that his spirit may be saved on the day of the Lord Jesus. |
| 6 <i>Your glorying is not good. Know ye not that a little leaven leaveneth the whole lump?</i> | Your boasting is not good. Do You not know that a little yeast leavens the whole batch of dough? |
| 7 <i>Purge out therefore the old leaven, that ye may be a new lump, as ye are unleavened. For even Christ our passover is sacrificed for us:</i> | Remove the old yeast so that You may be a fresh batch, as You truly are without yeast. For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed. |
| 8 <i>Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old leaven, neither with the leaven of malice and wickedness; but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.</i> | Therefore let us keep the feast — not with the old yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth. |

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| 9 | <i>I wrote unto you in an epistle not to company with fornicators:</i> | I wrote to You in my letter not to associate with sexually immoral people— |
| 10 | <i>Yet not altogether with the fornicators of this world, or with the covetous, or extortioners, or with idolaters; for then must ye needs go out of the world.</i> | not at all meaning the sexually immoral of this world, or the greedy and swindlers, or idolaters, for then You would have to go out of the world. |
| 11 | <i>But now I have written unto you not to keep company, if any man that is called a brother be a fornicator, or covetous, or an idolater, or a railer, or a drunkard, or an extortioner; with such an one no not to eat.</i> | But now I am writing to You not to associate with anyone who bears the name of brother if he is sexually immoral, greedy, an idolater, a slanderer, a drunkard, or a swindler — not even to eat with such a person. |
| 12 | <i>For what have I to do to judge them also that are without? do not ye judge them that are within?</i> | What business is it of mine to judge those outside the church? Are You not to judge those inside? |
| 13 | <i>But them that are without God judgeth. Therefore put away from among yourselves that wicked person.</i> | God will judge those outside. "Remove the wicked person from among you." |

Words in this chapter:

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 21:8; Rev 2:21; Col 3:5; Eph 5:3; Lev 18:8
v2 — Rev 2:20-22
v3 — Col 2:5; 1 Thess 2:17
v4 — John 20:23; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Cor 13:3; Matt 18:16-18; Col 3:17
v5 — 1 Tim 1:20; 2 Thess 3:14-15; Gal 6:1-2; Jas 5:19-20; Job 2:6
v6 — Gal 5:9; 1 Cor 15:33; Jas 4:16
v7 — 1 Pet 1:19-20; Eph 4:22; Col 3:5-9; John 1:29; Acts 8:32-35
v8 — 1 Pet 2:1-2; Ex 12:15; Deut 16:3; Luke 12:1; Mark 8:15
v9 — Eph 5:11; 2 Thess 3:14; 2 Cor 6:14; 2 Thess 3:6
v10 — 1 Cor 10:27
v11 — Rom 16:17; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Thess 3:14; Matt 18:17; 1 Cor 5:13

v13 — Deut 17:7; Deut 13:5; Deut 21:21; Matt 18:17; Deut 22:24

Chapter 6

Paul rebukes believers for taking disputes before unbelieving judges instead of settling them within the church. He warns that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God and declares that the body is the temple of the Holy Ghost — therefore they must flee fornication and glorify God in their body.

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| 1 <i>Dare any of you, having a matter against another, go to law before the unjust, and not before the saints?</i> | When any of You has a dispute with another, how dare You take it before the unrighteous rather than before the saints? |
| 2 <i>Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world? and if the world shall be judged by you, are ye unworthy to judge the smallest matters?</i> | Do You not know that the saints will judge the world? And if the world is to be judged by You, are You not competent to judge trivial matters? |
| 3 <i>Know ye not that we shall judge angels? how much more things that pertain to this life?</i> | Do You not know that we will judge angels? How much more, then, things of this life! |
| 4 <i>If then ye have judgments of things pertaining to this life, set them to judge who are least esteemed in the church.</i> | If You have disputes about such matters, why do You appoint as judges those who are of no standing in the church? |
| 5 <i>I speak to your shame. Is it so, that there is not a wise man among you? no, not one that shall be able to judge between his brethren?</i> | I say this to shame You. Is there really no one among you wise enough to judge between his brothers? |
| 6 <i>But brother goeth to law with brother, and that before the unbelievers.</i> | Instead, one brother takes another to court — and this before unbelievers! |
| 7 <i>Now therefore there is utterly a fault among you, because ye go to law one with another. Why do ye not rather take wrong? why do ye not rather suffer yourselves to be defrauded?</i> | The very fact that You have lawsuits among yourselves is already a failure. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be cheated? |

- 8 *Nay, ye do wrong, and defraud, and that your brethren.* Instead, You yourselves wrong and cheat — and You do this to Your brothers!
- 9 *Know ye not that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? Be not deceived: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind,* Do You not know that the unrighteous will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor the effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind,
- 10 *Nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God.* nor thieves, nor the greedy, nor drunkards, nor slanderers, nor swindlers will inherit the kingdom of God.
- 11 *And such were some of you: but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of the Lord Jesus, and by the Spirit of our God.* Such were some of You. But You were washed, You were sanctified, You were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God.
- 12 *All things are lawful unto me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but I will not be brought under the power of any.* "All things are lawful for me," but not all things are beneficial. "All things are lawful for me," but I will not be mastered by anything.
- 13 *Meats for the belly, and the belly for meats: but God shall destroy both it and them. Now the body is not for fornication, but for the Lord; and the Lord for the body.* "Food is for the stomach and the stomach for food," and God will do away with both. But the body is not for sexual immorality — it is for the Lord, and the Lord for the body.
- 14 *And God hath both raised up the Lord, and will also raise up us by his own power.* God raised the Lord and will also raise us by His power.
- 15 *Know ye not that your bodies are the members of Christ? shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them the members of an harlot? God forbid.* Do You not know that Your bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ and join them to a prostitute? Not at all!

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| <p>16 <i>What? know ye not that he which is joined to an harlot is one body? for two, saith he, shall be one flesh.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But he that is joined unto the Lord is one spirit.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Flee fornication. Every sin that a man doeth is without the body; but he that committeth fornication sinneth against his own body.</i></p> <p>19 <i>What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?</i></p> <p>20 <i>For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.</i></p> | <p>Do You not know that He who joins himself to a prostitute is one body with her? "The two," He says, "will become one flesh."</p> <p>But He who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with him.</p> <p>Flee from sexual immorality. Every other sin a person commits is outside the body, but the one who is sexually immoral sins against his own body.</p> <p>Do You not know that Your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost Who is in You, whom You have from God? You are not Your own,</p> <p>for You were bought with a price. So glorify God in Your body and in Your spirit, which are God's.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Cross-References:

v2 — Matt 19:28; Dan 7:22; Rev 20:4; Luke 22:30; Rev 3:21
v7 — Rom 12:17-19; Prov 20:22; 1 Pet 2:19-23; 1 Pet 3:9; Matt 5:39-41
v9 — 1 Tim 1:9-10; Gal 5:19-21; Eph 5:4-5; Lev 20:13; Rev 22:15
v10 — 1 Cor 5:11; Gal 5:21; Ezek 22:29; Eph 4:28; Ezek 22:27
v11 — 1 Cor 1:30; Col 3:5-7; 1 Cor 1:2; Rom 6:17-19; Acts 22:16
v12 — 1 Cor 10:23-33; 1 Cor 9:27; Heb 12:15-16; Rom 14:14-23; 1 Cor 8:7-13
v13 — 1 Cor 6:19; 1 Cor 3:16; Rom 6:12; 1 Cor 6:15; 1 Thess 4:3-7
v16 — Gen 2:24; Eph 5:31; Mark 10:8; Matt 19:5-6
v17 — John 17:21-23; Gal 2:20; 1 Cor 12:13; John 3:6; Eph 4:3-4
v18 — 1 Pet 2:11; 1 Thess 4:3; Col 3:5; Rom 6:12-13; 2 Tim 2:22
v19 — 1 Cor 3:16; 2 Cor 6:16; 1 Pet 2:5; Eph 2:21-22; 1 Cor 6:15-16
v20 — 1 Cor 7:23; Rom 12:1; 1 Pet 2:9; 1 Pet 1:18; Heb 9:12

Chapter 7

Paul addresses questions about marriage, teaching that each man should have his own wife and each woman her own husband, and that the married should not seek to be loosed. He counsels the unmarried and widows that it is good to remain single as he is, but if they cannot exercise self-control, it is better to marry than to burn.

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| 1 | <i>Now concerning the things whereof ye wrote unto me: It is good for a man not to touch a woman.</i> | Now concerning the things you wrote to me: it is good for a man not to touch a woman. |
| 2 | <i>Nevertheless, to avoid fornication, let every man have his own wife, and let every woman have her own husband.</i> | But because of the temptation to sexual immorality, each man should have his own wife and each woman her own husband. |
| 3 | <i>Let the husband render unto the wife due benevolence: and likewise also the wife unto the husband.</i> | The husband should give to his wife her conjugal rights, and likewise the wife to her husband. |
| 4 | <i>The wife hath not power of her own body, but the husband: and likewise also the husband hath not power of his own body, but the wife.</i> | The wife does not have authority over her own body, but the husband does. Likewise, the husband does not have authority over his own body, but the wife does. |
| 5 | <i>Defraud ye not one the other, except it be with consent for a time, that ye may give yourselves to fasting and prayer; and come together again, that Satan tempt you not for your incontinency.</i> | Do not deprive each other except by mutual consent for a time, so that you may devote yourselves to prayer. Then come together again, so that Satan does not tempt you because of your lack of self-control. |
| 6 | <i>But I speak this by permission, and not of commandment.</i> | I say this as a concession, not as a command. |
| 7 | <i>For I would that all men were even as I myself. But every man hath his proper gift of God, one after this manner, and another after that.</i> | I wish that all men were as I am. But each person has his own gift from God — one of one kind and one of another. |
| 8 | <i>I say therefore to the unmarried and widows, It is good for them if they abide even as I.</i> | To the unmarried and to widows I say: it is good for them to remain unmarried, as I am. |

- 9 *But if they cannot contain, let them marry: for it is better to marry than to burn.* But if they cannot exercise self-control, they should marry. It is better to marry than to burn with passion.
- 10 *And unto the married I command, yet not I, but the Lord, Let not the wife depart from her husband:* To the married I give this charge — not I, but the Lord — a wife must not separate from her husband.
- 11 *But and if she depart, let her remain unmarried, or be reconciled to her husband: and let not the husband put away his wife.* But if she does separate, she must either remain unmarried or be reconciled to her husband. And a husband must not divorce his wife.
- 12 *But to the rest speak I, not the Lord: If any brother hath a wife that believeth not, and she be pleased to dwell with him, let him not put her away.* To the rest I say — I, not the Lord — if any brother has a wife who is an unbeliever and she is willing to live with Him, He must not divorce her.
- 13 *And the woman which hath an husband that believeth not, and if he be pleased to dwell with her, let her not leave him.* And if a woman has a husband who is an unbeliever and he is willing to live with her, she must not divorce him.
- 14 *For the unbelieving husband is sanctified by the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified by the husband: else were your children unclean; but now are they holy.* For the unbelieving husband is sanctified through his believing wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified through her believing husband. Otherwise your children would be unclean, but as it is, they are holy.
- 15 *But if the unbelieving depart, let him depart. A brother or a sister is not under bondage in such cases: but God hath called us to peace.* But if the unbeliever leaves, let them leave. The brother or sister is not bound in such circumstances. God has called us to live in peace.
- 16 *For what knowest thou, O wife, whether thou shalt save thy husband? or how knowest thou, O man, whether thou shalt save thy wife?* How do you know, wife, whether you will save your husband? Or how do you know, husband, whether you will save your wife?

- 17 *But as God hath distributed to every man, as the Lord hath called every one, so let him walk. And so ordain I in all churches.* Each person should live the life the Lord has assigned to Him and to which God has called Him. This is the rule I lay down in all the churches.
- 18 *Is any man called being circumcised? let him not become uncircumcised. Is any called in uncircumcision? let him not be circumcised.* Was a man already circumcised when he was called? He should not seek to become uncircumcised. Was a man uncircumcised when he was called? He should not be circumcised.
- 19 *Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but the keeping of the commandments of God.* Circumcision is nothing and uncircumcision is nothing. What matters is keeping the commandments of God.
- 20 *Let every man abide in the same calling wherein he was called.* Each person should remain in the condition in which he was called.
- 21 *Art thou called being a servant? care not for it: but if thou mayest be made free, use it rather.* Were you a slave when you were called? Do not let it trouble you — although if you can gain your freedom, do so.
- 22 *For he that is called in the Lord, being a servant, is the Lord's freeman: likewise also he that is called, being free, is Christ's servant.* For the one who was a slave when called in the Lord is the Lord's free man. Likewise, the one who was free when called is Christ's slave.
- 23 *Ye are bought with a price; be not ye the servants of men.* You were bought with a price; do not become servants of men.
- 24 *Brethren, let every man, wherein he is called, therein abide with God.* Brothers, each person should remain with God in the condition in which He was called.
- 25 *Now concerning virgins I have no commandment of the Lord: yet I give my judgment, as one that hath obtained mercy of the Lord to be faithful.* Now concerning virgins: I have no command from the Lord, but I give my judgment as one who by the Lord's mercy is trustworthy.

- 26 *I suppose therefore that this is good for the present distress, I say, that it is good for a man so to be.* I think that in view of the present distress, it is good for a man to remain as he is.
- 27 *Art thou bound unto a wife? seek not to be loosed. Art thou loosed from a wife? seek not a wife.* Are You bound to a wife? Do not seek to be released. Are You free from a wife? Do not seek a wife.
- 28 *But and if thou marry, thou hast not sinned; and if a virgin marry, she hath not sinned. Nevertheless such shall have trouble in the flesh: but I spare you.* But if You do marry, You have not sinned. And if a virgin marries, she has not sinned. Yet those who marry will have trouble in this life, and I am trying to spare You that.
- 29 *But this I say, brethren, the time is short: it remaineth, that both they that have wives be as though they had none;* What I mean, brothers, is that the time is short. From now on, those who have wives should live as if they had none;
- 30 *And they that weep, as though they wept not; and they that rejoice, as though they rejoiced not; and they that buy, as though they possessed not;* those who mourn, as if they did not mourn; those who rejoice, as if they did not rejoice; those who buy, as if they did not own anything;
- 31 *And they that use this world, as not abusing it: for the fashion of this world passeth away.* those who make use of the world, as if they did not make full use of it. For the present form of this world is passing away.
- 32 *But I would have you without carefulness. He that is unmarried careth for the things that belong to the Lord, how he may please the Lord:* I want You to be free from anxiety. The unmarried man is concerned about the things of the Lord — how He may please the Lord.
- 33 *But he that is married careth for the things that are of the world, how he may please his wife.* But the married man is concerned about worldly things — how He may please his wife—

- 34 *There is difference also between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman careth for the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit: but she that is married careth for the things of the world, how she may please her husband.* and His interests are divided. The unmarried woman or virgin is concerned about the things of the Lord, to be holy in body and spirit. But the married woman is concerned about worldly things — how she may please her husband.
- 35 *And this I speak for your own profit; not that I may cast a snare upon you, but for that which is comely, and that ye may attend upon the Lord without distraction.* I am saying this for Your own benefit, not to put any restriction on You, but to promote what is right and to help You give Your undivided attention to the Lord.
- 36 *But if any man think that he behaveth himself uncomely toward his virgin, if she pass the flower of her age, and need so require, let him do what he will, he sinneth not: let them marry.* If any man thinks He is behaving improperly toward His virgin, if she is past the flower of her age, and need so requires, let Him do as He will — he does not sin: let them marry.
- 37 *Nevertheless he that standeth stedfast in his heart, having no necessity, but hath power over his own will, and hath so decreed in his heart that he will keep his virgin, doeth well.* But the man who stands firm in his resolve — who is under no compulsion but has control over his own desire and has made up his mind to keep her as his fiancée — does well.
- 38 *So then he that giveth her in marriage doeth well; but he that giveth her not in marriage doeth better.* So then, he who marries his fiancée does well, and he who does not marry does even better.
- 39 *The wife is bound by the law as long as her husband liveth; but if her husband be dead, she is at liberty to be married to whom she will; only in the Lord.* A wife is bound to her husband as long as he lives. But if her husband dies, she is free to marry anyone she wishes, but only in the Lord.
- 40 *But she is happier if she so abide, after my judgment: and I think also that I have the Spirit of God.* In my judgment, she is happier if she remains unmarried. And I think that I too have the Spirit of God.

Words in this chapter:

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Eph 5:28; Eph 5:33; 1 Cor 7:9; Prov 18:22; Prov 5:18-19
- v3 — 1 Pet 3:7; Ex 21:10
- v7 — Matt 19:11-12; 1 Cor 9:5; Rom 12:6; 1 Cor 7:8; 1 Cor 12:4
- v10 — Matt 5:32; Luke 16:18; Mal 2:14-16; Matt 19:3-9; Mark 10:11-12
- v14 — Mal 2:15-16; 1 Tim 4:5; Titus 1:15; Isa 52:1
- v17 — 1 Cor 4:17; 1 Cor 7:24; Rom 12:3-8; 1 Cor 7:20-21; 2 Cor 8:18
- v23 — 1 Cor 6:20; 1 Pet 1:18-19; Titus 2:14; Lev 25:42; Rev 5:9
- v29 — 1 John 2:17; 1 Cor 7:31; Rom 13:11-12; Jas 4:13-16; Heb 13:13-14
- v31 — 1 John 2:17; 1 Pet 4:7; Luke 21:34; Jas 4:14; 1 Pet 1:24
- v32 — Matt 6:25-34; 1 Tim 5:5; Phil 4:6; Ps 55:22
- v35 — 1 Cor 7:33-34; 1 Cor 7:36; Luke 8:14; 1 Cor 7:2; Phil 4:8
- v39 — Rom 7:2-3; 2 Cor 6:14-16; 1 Cor 7:10

Chapter 8

Paul addresses food offered to idols, teaching that an idol is nothing and that there is one God and one Lord Jesus Christ. He warns that knowledge puffs up but charity builds up, and that believers must be careful not to use their liberty in a way that causes a weaker brother to stumble.

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| 1 | <i>Now as touching things offered unto idols, we know that we all have knowledge. Knowledge puffeth up, but charity edifieth.</i> | Now concerning food offered to idols: we know that "we all possess knowledge." Knowledge puffs up, but charity builds up. |
| 2 | <i>And if any man think that he knoweth any thing, he knoweth nothing yet as he ought to know.</i> | If anyone thinks he knows something, he does not yet know it as He ought to know it. |
| 3 | <i>But if any man love God, the same is known of him.</i> | But if anyone loves God, He is known by God. |
| 4 | <i>As concerning therefore the eating of those things that are offered in sacrifice unto idols, we know that an idol is nothing in the world, and that there is none other God but one.</i> | So then, about eating food sacrificed to idols: we know that an idol is nothing in the world and that there is no God but one. |

- 5 *For though there be that are called gods, whether in heaven or in earth, (as there be gods many, and lords many,)* For even if there are so-called gods, whether in heaven or on earth — and there are many such gods and lords—
- 6 *But to us there is but one God, the Father, of whom are all things, and we in him; and one Lord Jesus Christ, by whom are all things, and we by him.* yet for us there is one God, the Father, from whom all things came and for whom we exist. And there is one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom all things were made and through whom we exist.
- 7 *Howbeit there is not in every man that knowledge: for some with conscience of the idol unto this hour eat it as a thing offered unto an idol; and their conscience being weak is defiled.* But not everyone possesses this knowledge. Some people, still accustomed to idols, eat such food as if it were really sacrificed to an idol, and their weak conscience is defiled.
- 8 *But meat commendeth us not to God: for neither, if we eat, are we the better; neither, if we eat not, are we the worse.* Food does not bring us near to God — we are no worse if we do not eat, and no better if we do.
- 9 *But take heed lest by any means this liberty of yours become a stumblingblock to them that are weak.* Be careful, however, that Your freedom does not become a stumbling block to the weak.
- 10 *For if any man see thee which hast knowledge sit at meat in the idol's temple, shall not the conscience of him which is weak be emboldened to eat those things which are offered to idols;* For if someone with a weak conscience sees you, who have knowledge, eating in an idol's temple, will He not be encouraged to eat what is sacrificed to idols?
- 11 *And through thy knowledge shall the weak brother perish, for whom Christ died?* So this weak brother, for whom Christ died, is destroyed by Your knowledge.
- 12 *But when ye sin so against the brethren, and wound their weak conscience, ye sin against Christ.* When You sin against Your brothers in this way and wound their weak conscience, You sin against Christ.

- 13

Wherefore, if meat make my brother to offend, I will eat no flesh while the world standeth, lest I make my brother to offend.
- Therefore, if what I eat causes my brother to fall, I will never eat meat again, rather than cause my brother to stumble.

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Cor 8:7; Isa 5:21; Rom 14:3; 1 Cor 8:4; Rev 2:14
- v2 — 1 Cor 13:12; 1 Cor 3:18; Gal 6:3; Prov 26:12; 1 Tim 6:3-4
- v3 — Rev 3:8-9; Ex 33:17; Nah 1:7; 2 Tim 2:19; 1 Cor 2:9
- v4 — Deut 4:39; Eph 4:6; 1 Cor 10:19-20; Deut 6:4; Isa 41:24
- v5 — 2 Thess 2:4; Gal 4:8; Jer 2:28
- v6 — Rom 11:36; John 1:3; Mal 2:10; Heb 1:2-3; Col 1:16-17
- v7 — Rom 14:14; 1 Cor 10:28-29; Rom 14:22-23; 1 Cor 8:9-10
- v8 — Rom 14:17; Heb 13:9; 1 Cor 6:13; Col 2:20-23
- v9 — Gal 5:13; Rom 14:20-21; 1 Pet 2:16; 2 Pet 2:19; 1 Cor 10:24
- v11 — Rom 14:15; Rom 15:1-3; 1 Cor 8:13
- v12 — Matt 18:6; Matt 25:45
- v13 — Rom 14:21; 2 Cor 6:3; 2 Cor 11:29; 1 Cor 6:12; 1 Cor 13:5

Chapter 9

Paul defends his apostleship and his right to financial support from those he serves, though he has not used that right so as not to hinder the gospel. He declares that he makes himself servant to all in order to win more, and disciplines his body like an athlete so that after preaching to others he himself is not disqualified.

- 1

Am I not an apostle? am I not free? have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord? are not ye my work in the Lord?
- Am I not free? Am I not an apostle? Have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord? Are You not my work in the Lord?
- 2

If I be not an apostle unto others, yet doubtless I am to you: for the seal of mine apostleship are ye in the Lord.
- Even if I am not an apostle to others, I certainly am to You! For You are the seal of my apostleship in the Lord.
- 3

Mine answer to them that do examine me is this,
- This is my defense to those who would examine me:

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| 4 <i>Have we not power to eat and to drink?</i> | Do we not have the right to eat and to drink? |
| 5 <i>Have we not power to lead about a sister, a wife, as well as other apostles, and as the brethren of the Lord, and Cephas?</i> | Do we not have the right to take a believing wife along with us, as do the other apostles and the Lord's brothers and Cephas? |
| 6 <i>Or I only and Barnabas, have not we power to forbear working?</i> | Or is it only I and Barnabas who have no right to stop working for a living? |
| 7 <i>Who goeth a warfare any time at his own charges? who planteth a vineyard, and eateth not of the fruit thereof? or who feedeth a flock, and eateth not of the milk of the flock?</i> | Who serves as a soldier at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard and does not eat its fruit? Who tends a flock and does not drink the milk from the flock? |
| 8 <i>Say I these things as a man? or saith not the law the same also?</i> | Do I say this on human authority? Does not the law also say the same? |
| 9 <i>For it is written in the law of Moses, Thou shalt not muzzle the mouth of the ox that treadeth out the corn. Doth God take care for oxen?</i> | For in the law of Moses it is written: "Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain." Is it about oxen that God is concerned? |
| 10 <i>Or saith he it altogether for our sakes? For our sakes, no doubt, this is written: that he that ploweth should plow in hope; and that he that thresheth in hope should be partaker of his hope.</i> | Surely He says this for our sake, doesn't He? Yes, it was written for us, because the one who plows and the one who threshes should both work in the hope of sharing in the harvest. |
| 11 <i>If we have sown unto you spiritual things, is it a great thing if we shall reap your carnal things?</i> | If we sowed spiritual seed among you, is it too much to reap a material harvest from you? |
| 12 <i>If others be partakers of this power over you, are not we rather? Nevertheless we have not used this power; but suffer all things, lest we should hinder the gospel of Christ.</i> | If others exercise this right over You, should we not even more? But we did not use this right. On the contrary, we endure everything so as not to put any obstacle in the way of the gospel of Christ. |

- 13 *Do ye not know that they which minister about holy things live of the things of the temple? and they which wait at the altar are partakers with the altar?* Do You not know that those who work in the temple get their food from the temple, and those who serve at the altar share in the offerings of the altar?
- 14 *Even so hath the Lord ordained that they which preach the gospel should live of the gospel.* In the same way, the Lord has commanded that those who preach the gospel should receive their living from the gospel.
- 15 *But I have used none of these things: neither have I written these things, that it should be so done unto me: for it were better for me to die, than that any man should make my glorying void.* But I have not used any of these rights. And I am not writing this to get such treatment. I would rather die than have anyone deprive me of this boast.
- 16 *For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!* For if I preach the gospel, I have no reason to boast, since I am compelled to preach it. Woe to me if I do not preach the gospel!
- 17 *For if I do this thing willingly, I have a reward: but if against my will, a dispensation of the gospel is committed unto me.* If I do this voluntarily, I have a reward. But if not voluntarily, I am still entrusted with a stewardship.
- 18 *What is my reward then? Verily that, when I preach the gospel, I may make the gospel of Christ without charge, that I abuse not my power in the gospel.* What then is my reward? That when I preach the gospel I may offer it free of charge, and not make full use of my rights in the gospel.
- 19 *For though I be free from all men, yet have I made myself servant unto all, that I might gain the more.* Though I am free from everyone, I have made myself a servant to all, that I might win more of them.

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| <p>20 <i>And unto the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain the Jews; to them that are under the law, as under the law, that I might gain them that are under the law;</i></p> | <p>To the Jews I became like a Jew in order to win the Jews. To those under the law I became like one under the law, so I might win those under the law.</p> |
| <p>21 <i>To them that are without law, as without law, (being not without law to God, but under the law to Christ,) that I might gain them that are without law.</i></p> | <p>To those outside the law I became like one outside the law — not being outside God's law but inside Christ's law — in order to win those outside the law.</p> |
| <p>22 <i>To the weak became I as weak, that I might gain the weak: I am made all things to all men, that I might by all means save some.</i></p> | <p>To the weak I became weak, to win the weak. I have become all things to all people so that by all possible means I might save some.</p> |
| <p>23 <i>And this I do for the gospel's sake, that I might be partaker thereof with you.</i></p> | <p>I do all this for the sake of the gospel, so that I may share in its blessings.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>Know ye not that they which run in a race run all, but one receiveth the prize? So run, that ye may obtain.</i></p> | <p>Do You not know that in a race all the runners run, but only one gets the prize? Run in such a way as to get the prize.</p> |
| <p>25 <i>And every man that striveth for the mastery is temperate in all things. Now they do it to obtain a corruptible crown; but we an incorruptible.</i></p> | <p>Everyone who competes for the prize is temperate in all things. They do it to obtain a corruptible crown, but we an incorruptible.</p> |
| <p>26 <i>I therefore so run, not as uncertainly; so fight I, not as one that beateth the air:</i></p> | <p>Therefore I do not run aimlessly; I do not fight like a man beating the air.</p> |
| <p>27 <i>But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.</i></p> | <p>No, I beat my body and make it my slave, so that after preaching to others, I myself will not be disqualified for the prize.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Cross-References:

- v9 — Deut 25:4; 1 Tim 5:18; Ps 104:27
- v11 — Rom 15:27; Gal 6:6; 2 Cor 11:15; Matt 10:10
- v12 — 1 Cor 9:15; 2 Cor 11:12; 1 Cor 9:18; 2 Cor 11:7-10; 1 Thess 2:6-9
- v14 — Matt 10:10; 1 Tim 5:17-18; 1 Cor 9:4; Gal 6:6; Luke 10:7
- v16 — Rom 1:14; Jer 20:9; Col 4:17; Luke 9:62; Acts 26:16-20
- v19 — Gal 5:13; Matt 18:15; 1 Cor 10:33; Jas 5:19-20; 1 Tim 4:16
- v21 — Rom 2:12; Rom 2:14; Gal 3:2; 1 Cor 7:19-22; Matt 5:17-20
- v22 — 1 Cor 10:33; Rom 15:1; 1 Cor 9:19; Rom 11:14; Gal 6:1
- v24 — Phil 3:14; Heb 12:1; 2 Tim 4:7-8; Rev 3:11; Phil 2:16
- v25 — 2 Tim 2:5; Rev 2:10; 1 Tim 6:12; 2 Tim 4:7-8; Jas 1:12
- v26 — 2 Pet 1:10; 2 Tim 2:5; Phil 1:21; Col 1:29
- v27 — Rom 8:13; 1 Cor 9:25; Col 3:5; 2 Cor 13:5-6; 1 Pet 2:11

Chapter 10

Paul warns that Israel's failures in the wilderness were written for our example, and urges them to flee from idolatry. He teaches that the cup of blessing and the bread are a communion in the blood and body of Christ, and that believers cannot partake of the Lord's table and the table of devils. Whether they eat or drink, they should do all to the glory of God.

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| 1 | <i>Moreover, brethren, I would not that ye should be ignorant, how that all our fathers were under the cloud, and all passed through the sea;</i> | I do not want You to be unaware, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud and all passed through the sea. |
| 2 | <i>And were all baptized unto Moses in the cloud and in the sea;</i> | They were all baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea. |
| 3 | <i>And did all eat the same spiritual meat;</i> | They all ate the same spiritual food, |
| 4 | <i>And did all drink the same spiritual drink: for they drank of that spiritual Rock that followed them: and that Rock was Christ.</i> | and all drank the same spiritual drink. They drank from the spiritual Rock that followed them, and that Rock was Christ. |
| 5 | <i>But with many of them God was not well pleased: for they were overthrown in the wilderness.</i> | Nevertheless, God was not pleased with most of them, for they were struck down in the wilderness. |

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| <p>6 <i>Now these things were our examples, to the intent we should not lust after evil things, as they also lusted.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Neither be ye idolaters, as were some of them; as it is written, The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Neither let us commit fornication, as some of them committed, and fell in one day three and twenty thousand.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Neither let us tempt Christ, as some of them also tempted, and were destroyed of serpents.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Neither murmur ye, as some of them also murmured, and were destroyed of the destroyer.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Now all these things happened unto them for ensamples: and they are written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the world are come.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Wherefore let him that thinketh he standeth take heed lest he fall.</i></p> <p>13 <i>There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Wherefore, my dearly beloved, flee from idolatry.</i></p> <p>15 <i>I speak as to wise men; judge ye what I say.</i></p> | <p>Now these things happened as examples for us, so that we would not crave evil things as they did.</p> <p>Do not become idolaters, as some of them were. As it is written: "The people sat down to eat and drink and rose up to play."</p> <p>We must not commit sexual immorality, as some of them did — and in one day twenty-three thousand of them fell.</p> <p>We must not test Christ, as some of them did — and were killed by snakes.</p> <p>And do not grumble, as some of them did — and were killed by the destroying angel.</p> <p>These things happened to them as examples and were written for our admonition, on whom the ends of the world are come.</p> <p>So if You think You are standing firm, be careful that You do not fall.</p> <p>No temptation has overtaken You except what is common to man. God is faithful — He will not let You be tempted beyond what You can bear. With the temptation He will also provide a way of escape, so that You may be able to endure it.</p> <p>Therefore, my dear friends, flee from idolatry.</p> <p>I speak to sensible people — judge for yourselves what I say.</p> |
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- 16 *The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ?* The cup of blessing that we bless — is it not a participation in the blood of Christ? The bread that we break — is it not a participation in the body of Christ?
- 17 *For we being many are one bread, and one body: for we are all partakers of that one bread.* Because there is one bread, we who are many are one body, for we all partake of the one bread.
- 18 *Behold Israel after the flesh: are not they which eat of the sacrifices partakers of the altar?* Consider the people of Israel: do not those who eat the sacrifices participate in the altar?
- 19 *What say I then? that the idol is any thing, or that which is offered in sacrifice to idols is any thing?* What am I saying then? That food sacrificed to an idol is anything, or that an idol is anything?
- 20 *But I say, that the things which the Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to devils, and not to God: and I would not that ye should have fellowship with devils.* No, I am saying that what pagans sacrifice, they sacrifice to demons and not to God. I do not want You to be participants with demons.
- 21 *Ye cannot drink the cup of the Lord, and the cup of devils: ye cannot be partakers of the Lord's table, and of the table of devils.* You cannot drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons. You cannot partake of the Lord's table and the table of demons.
- 22 *Do we provoke the Lord to jealousy? are we stronger than he?* Are we trying to provoke the Lord to jealousy? Are we stronger than He?
- 23 *All things are lawful for me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but all things edify not.* "All things are lawful," but not all things are beneficial. "All things are lawful," but not all things build up.
- 24 *Let no man seek his own, but every man another's wealth.* Let no one seek his own good, but the good of his neighbor.
- 25 *Whatsoever is sold in the shambles, that eat, asking no question for conscience sake:* Eat whatever is sold in the market without raising any question on the grounds of conscience.

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| <p>26 <i>For the earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof.</i></p> <p>27 <i>If any of them that believe not bid you to a feast, and ye be disposed to go; whatsoever is set before you, eat, asking no question for conscience sake.</i></p> <p>28 <i>But if any man say unto you, This is offered in sacrifice unto idols, eat not for his sake that shewed it, and for conscience sake: for the earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof:</i></p> <p>29 <i>Conscience, I say, not thine own, but of the other: for why is my liberty judged of another man's conscience?</i></p> <p>30 <i>For if I by grace be a partaker, why am I evil spoken of for that for which I give thanks?</i></p> <p>31 <i>Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.</i></p> <p>32 <i>Give none offence, neither to the Jews, nor to the Gentiles, nor to the church of God:</i></p> <p>33 <i>Even as I please all men in all things, not seeking mine own profit, but the profit of many, that they may be saved.</i></p> | <p>"For the earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."</p> <p>If an unbeliever invites You to a meal and You want to go, eat whatever is placed before You without raising questions of conscience.</p> <p>But if someone says to you, "This has been offered in sacrifice," then do not eat it, both for the sake of the one who told you and for the sake of conscience.</p> <p>I mean the other person's conscience, not Your own. For why should my freedom be judged by another's conscience?</p> <p>If I take part in a meal with thankfulness, why am I condemned for something I give thanks for?</p> <p>So whether You eat or drink or whatever You do, do it all to the glory of God.</p> <p>Give no offense to Jews or to Greeks or to the church of God—</p> <p>just as I try to please everyone in everything I do. I do not seek my own good but the good of many, so that they may be saved.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v4 — Ex 17:6; John 7:37; Isa 48:21; Ps 105:41; John 4:14
- v7 — Ex 32:6-8; Ps 106:19-20; 1 Cor 6:9; Deut 9:12; 1 Cor 10:14
- v8 — Num 25:1-9; 1 Cor 6:18; Ps 106:29; 1 Cor 6:9; Rev 2:14
- v9 — Num 21:5-6; Ps 78:18; Heb 3:8-11; Ex 17:2; Ex 17:7
- v10 — Num 14:2; Num 16:41; Num 14:37; Phil 2:14; 1 Chr 21:15
- v11 — Rom 15:4; Rom 13:11; 1 John 2:18; 1 Cor 9:10; Phil 4:5
- v12 — Rom 11:20; 2 Pet 3:17; Prov 16:18; 1 Cor 8:2; Matt 26:40-41
- v13 — 2 Pet 2:9; 2 Tim 4:18; 2 Thess 3:3; 1 Pet 5:8-9; Heb 12:4
- v21 — Matt 6:24; 1 Kgs 18:21; 2 Cor 6:15-17; Isa 65:11; 1 Cor 10:16
- v23 — 1 Cor 6:12; 1 Cor 8:9; Eph 4:29; Rom 14:19-20; 1 Thess 5:11
- v24 — Rom 15:1-2; Phil 2:4-5; 1 Cor 10:33; 1 Cor 9:19-23; Phil 2:21
- v31 — Col 3:17; Col 3:23; 1 Pet 4:11; Deut 12:7; Deut 12:18

Chapter 11

Paul teaches on head coverings, declaring that the head of every man is Christ, the head of the woman is the man, and the head of Christ is God. He rebukes the Corinthians for their divisions at the Lord's supper and delivers the institution of communion, warning that whoever eats and drinks unworthily eats and drinks damnation to himself.

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| 1 <i>Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of Christ.</i> | Follow my example, as I follow the example of Christ. |
| 2 <i>Now I praise you, brethren, that ye remember me in all things, and keep the ordinances, as I delivered them to you.</i> | I praise You for remembering me in everything and for holding to the traditions just as I passed them on to You. |
| 3 <i>But I would have you know, that the head of every man is Christ; and the head of the woman is the man; and the head of Christ is God.</i> | I want You to know that the head of every man is Christ, the head of a wife is her husband, and the head of Christ is God. |
| 4 <i>Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonoureth his head.</i> | Every man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors His head. |
| 5 <i>But every woman that prayeth or prophesieth with her head uncovered dishonoureth her head: for that is even all one as if she were shaven.</i> | Every woman who prays or prophesies with her head uncovered dishonors her head — it is just as if she had her head shaved. |

- 6 *For if the woman be not covered, let her also be shorn: but if it be a shame for a woman to be shorn or shaven, let her be covered.* If a woman does not cover her head, she should have her hair cut off. But if it is shameful for a woman to have her hair cut or her head shaved, she should cover her head.
- 7 *For a man indeed ought not to cover his head, forasmuch as he is the image and glory of God: but the woman is the glory of the man.* A man ought not to cover his head, since he is the image and glory of God. But the woman is the glory of the man.
- 8 *For the man is not of the woman; but the woman of the man.* For man did not come from woman, but woman from man.
- 9 *Neither was the man created for the woman; but the woman for the man.* Neither was man created for woman, but woman for man.
- 10 *For this cause ought the woman to have power on her head because of the angels.* For this reason a woman ought to have power on her head, because of the angels.
- 11 *Nevertheless neither is the man without the woman, neither the woman without the man, in the Lord.* Nevertheless, in the Lord woman is not independent of man, nor is man independent of woman.
- 12 *For as the woman is of the man, even so is the man also by the woman; but all things of God.* For as woman was made from man, so man is now born of woman. And everything comes from God.
- 13 *Judge in yourselves: is it comely that a woman pray unto God uncovered?* Judge for yourselves: is it proper for a woman to pray to God with her head uncovered?
- 14 *Doth not even nature itself teach you, that, if a man have long hair, it is a shame unto him?* Does not nature itself teach you that if a man wears his hair long, it is a disgrace to him,
- 15 *But if a woman have long hair, it is a glory to her: for her hair is given her for a covering.* but if a woman has long hair, it is her glory? For her hair is given to her as a covering.
- 16 *But if any man seem to be contentious, we have no such custom, neither the churches of God.* If anyone wants to be contentious about this, we have no such practice — nor do the churches of God.

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| 17 <i>Now in this that I declare unto you I praise you not, that ye come together not for the better, but for the worse.</i> | In the following instructions I do not praise you, because your meetings do more harm than good. |
| 18 <i>For first of all, when ye come together in the church, I hear that there be divisions among you; and I partly believe it.</i> | First of all, when you come together as a church, I hear that divisions exist among you, and I partly believe it. |
| 19 <i>For there must be also heresies among you, that they which are approved may be made manifest among you.</i> | No doubt there have to be differences among you to show which of you are approved. |
| 20 <i>When ye come together therefore into one place, this is not to eat the Lord's supper.</i> | When you come together in one place, it is not really to eat the Lord's Supper. |
| 21 <i>For in eating every one taketh before other his own supper: and one is hungry, and another is drunken.</i> | For when you eat, each of you goes ahead without waiting for anyone else. One remains hungry while another gets drunk. |
| 22 <i>What? have ye not houses to eat and to drink in? or despise ye the church of God, and shame them that have not? What shall I say to you? shall I praise you in this? I praise you not.</i> | Don't you have homes to eat and drink in? Or do you despise the church of God and humiliate those who have nothing? What shall I say to you? Shall I praise you? Certainly not! |
| 23 <i>For I have received of the Lord that which also I delivered unto you, That the Lord Jesus the same night in which he was betrayed took bread:</i> | For I received from the Lord what I also passed on to You: the Lord Jesus, on the night He was betrayed, took bread, |
| 24 <i>And when he had given thanks, he brake it, and said, Take, eat: this is my body, which is broken for you: this do in remembrance of me.</i> | and when He had given thanks, He broke it and said: "Take, eat — this is My body which is broken for You. Do this in remembrance of Me." |

- 25 *After the same manner also he took the cup, when he had supped, saying, This cup is the new testament in my blood: this do ye, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.* In the same way, after supper He took the cup, saying: "This cup is the new testament in My blood. Do this, as often as You drink it, in remembrance of Me."
- 26 *For as often as ye eat this bread, and drink this cup, ye do shew the Lord's death till he come.* For as often as You eat this bread and drink this cup, You proclaim the Lord's death until He comes.
- 27 *Wherefore whosoever shall eat this bread, and drink this cup of the Lord, unworthily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord.* Therefore whoever eats the bread or drinks the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty of sinning against the body and blood of the Lord.
- 28 *But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of that bread, and drink of that cup.* A person should examine Himself before eating the bread and drinking the cup.
- 29 *For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself, not discerning the Lord's body.* For anyone who eats and drinks without discerning the Lord's body eats and drinks damnation to Himself.
- 30 *For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep.* That is why many among You are weak and sick, and a number of You have fallen asleep.
- 31 *For if we would judge ourselves, we should not be judged.* But if we judged ourselves properly, we would not come under judgment.
- 32 *But when we are judged, we are chastened of the Lord, that we should not be condemned with the world.* When we are judged by the Lord, we are disciplined so that we may not be condemned along with the world.
- 33 *Wherefore, my brethren, when ye come together to eat, tarry one for another.* So then, my brothers, when You come together to eat, wait for one another.

- 34

And if any man hunger, let him eat at home; that ye come not together unto condemnation. And the rest will I set in order when I come.
- If anyone is hungry, he should eat at home, so that when You meet together You do not come under judgment. The other matters I will set in order when I come.

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Phil 3:17; 1 Thess 1:6; 1 Cor 4:16; Eph 5:1-2; Heb 6:12
- v2 — 2 Thess 2:15; Prov 31:28-31; 1 Cor 4:17; 1 Cor 11:17; 2 Thess 3:6
- v3 — Gen 3:16; Col 1:18; 1 Cor 3:23; Col 3:18; Eph 4:15
- v19 — 1 John 2:19; Titus 3:10; Acts 20:30; Luke 17:1; Deut 13:3
- v23 — Luke 22:19-20; Matt 26:26-28; 1 Cor 11:23-25; Mark 14:22-24; 1 Cor 15:3
- v24 — John 6:53-58; 1 Cor 11:27-28; 1 Cor 10:3-4; Isa 26:8; Ex 12:14
- v25 — Luke 22:20; Heb 9:15-20; Heb 13:20; 2 Cor 3:6
- v26 — Rev 1:7; Heb 9:28; John 14:3; Acts 1:11; 1 John 2:28
- v27 — John 6:51; 1 Cor 10:21; Heb 10:29; Num 9:13; Num 9:10
- v28 — Gal 6:4; 2 Cor 13:5; Lam 3:40; Matt 5:23-24; Ps 26:2-7
- v31 — 1 John 1:9; Ps 32:3-5; Rev 2:5; 1 Cor 11:28; Rev 3:2-3
- v32 — Heb 12:5-11; Prov 3:11-12; Ps 118:18; Rev 3:19; Job 5:17-18

Chapter 12

Paul teaches that there are diversities of gifts but the same Spirit, and that the Spirit distributes to each one individually as He wills. He uses the human body to illustrate that every member is necessary — the eye cannot say to the hand, "I have no need of you" — and that God has set the members in the body as it pleases Him.

- 1

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.
- Now concerning spiritual gifts, brothers, I do not want You to be unaware.
- 2

Ye know that ye were Gentiles, carried away unto these dumb idols, even as ye were led.
- You know that when You were Gentiles, You were led astray to mute idols, however You were led.

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| <p>3 <i>Wherefore I give you to understand, that no man speaking by the Spirit of God calleth Jesus accursed: and that no man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy Ghost.</i></p> <p>4 <i>Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And there are differences of administrations, but the same Lord.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And there are diversities of operations, but it is the same God which worketh all in all.</i></p> <p>7 <i>But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal.</i></p> <p>8 <i>For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit;</i></p> <p>9 <i>To another faith by the same Spirit; to another the gifts of healing by the same Spirit;</i></p> <p>10 <i>To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues:</i></p> <p>11 <i>But all these worketh that one and the selfsame Spirit, dividing to every man severally as he will.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For as the body is one, and hath many members, and all the members of that one body, being many, are one body: so also is Christ.</i></p> | <p>Therefore I want You to know that no one speaking by the Spirit of God says "Jesus is cursed," and no one can say "Jesus is Lord" except by the Holy Ghost.</p> <p>There are different kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit.</p> <p>There are different kinds of service, but the same Lord.</p> <p>There are different kinds of working, but in all of them and in everyone it is the same God at work.</p> <p>Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.</p> <p>To one is given through the Spirit a word of wisdom, to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit,</p> <p>to another faith by the same Spirit, to another gifts of healing by the one Spirit,</p> <p>to another the working of miracles, to another prophecy, to another the ability to distinguish between spirits, to another various kinds of tongues, to another the interpretation of tongues.</p> <p>All these are the work of one and the same Spirit, and He gives them to each one just as he determines.</p> <p>Just as a body, though one, has many parts, and all the parts, though many, form one body — so it is with Christ.</p> |
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- 13 *For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit.* For we were all baptized by one Spirit into one body — whether Jews or Greeks, whether slaves or free — and we were all given the one Spirit to drink.
- 14 *For the body is not one member, but many.* Now the body is not made up of one part but of many.
- 15 *If the foot shall say, Because I am not the hand, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?* If the foot should say, "Because I am not a hand, I do not belong to the body," it would not for that reason stop being part of the body.
- 16 *And if the ear shall say, Because I am not the eye, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?* And if the ear should say, "Because I am not an eye, I do not belong to the body," it would not for that reason stop being part of the body.
- 17 *If the whole body were an eye, where were the hearing? If the whole were hearing, where were the smelling?* If the whole body were an eye, where would the sense of hearing be? If the whole body were an ear, where would the sense of smell be?
- 18 *But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.* But in fact God has placed the parts in the body, every one of them, just as he wanted them to be.
- 19 *And if they were all one member, where were the body?* If they were all one part, where would the body be?
- 20 *But now are they many members, yet but one body.* As it is, there are many parts, but one body.
- 21 *And the eye cannot say unto the hand, I have no need of thee: nor again the head to the feet, I have no need of you.* The eye cannot say to the hand, "I don't need You!" And the head cannot say to the feet, "I don't need You!"
- 22 *Nay, much more those members of the body, which seem to be more feeble, are necessary:* On the contrary, those parts of the body that seem to be weaker are all the more necessary,

- 23 *And those members of the body, which we think to be less honourable, upon these we bestow more abundant honour; and our uncomely parts have more abundant comeliness.* and those we think less honorable we clothe with special honor. Our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty,
- 24 *For our comely parts have no need: but God hath tempered the body together, having given more abundant honour to that part which lacked:* while our presentable parts have no such need. But God has put the body together, giving greater honor to the parts that lack it,
- 25 *That there should be no schism in the body; but that the members should have the same care one for another.* so that there should be no division in the body, but that its parts should have equal concern for each other.
- 26 *And whether one member suffer, all the members suffer with it; or one member be honoured, all the members rejoice with it.* If one part suffers, every part suffers with it. If one part is honored, every part rejoices with it.
- 27 *Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.* Now You are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it.
- 28 *And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.* And God has placed in the church first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracles, then gifts of healing, helpful deeds, gifts of leadership, and different kinds of tongues.
- 29 *Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?* Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Do all work miracles?
- 30 *Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?* Do all have gifts of healing? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret?
- 31 *But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.* But eagerly desire the greater gifts. And now I will show You the most excellent way.

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Pet 4:3; 1 Thess 1:9; Ps 115:5; Gal 4:8; Eph 2:11-12
- v3 — 1 John 4:2-3; Matt 16:16-17; Rom 10:9; 2 Cor 3:5; John 13:13
- v4 — 1 Pet 4:10; 1 Cor 12:28; Rom 12:4-6; Heb 2:4; 1 Cor 12:8-11
- v7 — 1 Pet 4:10-11; Rom 12:6-8; 1 Cor 14:19; 1 Cor 14:12; 1 Cor 14:17
- v9 — Jas 5:14-15; Eph 2:8; 2 Cor 4:13; Heb 11:33; 1 Cor 13:2
- v10 — 1 Cor 14:39; 1 John 4:1; Mark 16:17; 1 Cor 12:28-30; Joel 2:28
- v12 — Rom 12:4-5; Col 3:15; 1 Cor 12:27; Eph 4:15-16; Col 2:19
- v13 — Eph 4:5; Col 3:11; Gal 3:28; John 7:37-39; Rom 6:3-6
- v25 — 2 Cor 13:11; 1 Cor 1:10-12; John 17:21-26; 2 Cor 8:16
- v26 — Rom 12:15; Gal 6:2; Heb 13:3; 1 Pet 3:8
- v27 — Eph 4:12; Eph 5:30; Rom 12:5; Col 1:24; 1 Cor 12:12
- v28 — Eph 4:11-13; Rom 12:6-8; 1 Cor 12:18; 1 Cor 12:7-11; 1 Tim 5:17

Chapter 13

Paul declares that without charity, all gifts are nothing — tongues, prophecy, knowledge, and even faith that moves mountains amount to nothing without love. Charity suffers long and is kind, does not envy or boast, bears all things and endures all things. Prophecies, tongues, and knowledge will pass away, but faith, hope, and charity abide — and the greatest of these is charity.

- 1

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.
- If I speak in the tongues of men and of angels but have not charity, I am only a resounding gong or a clanging cymbal.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. In 1 Corinthians 13, Paul uses this word where most modern translations say "love." The KJV uses "charity" because this kind of love is not mere feeling — it is the highest, most self-giving love that comes from God Himself.

- 2

And though I have the gift of prophecy, and understand all mysteries, and all knowledge; and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, and have not charity, I am nothing.
- If I have the gift of prophecy and can understand all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have faith that can move mountains, but have not charity, I am nothing.

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| 3 <i>And though I bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and though I give my body to be burned, and have not charity, it profiteth me nothing.</i> | If I give all I possess to the poor and give my body to be burned, but have not charity, I gain nothing. |
| 4 <i>Charity suffereth long, and is kind; charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up,</i> | Charity is patient. Charity is kind. It does not envy. It does not boast. It is not proud. |
| 5 <i>Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil;</i> | It does not behave rudely. It is not self-seeking. It is not easily angered. It keeps no record of wrongs. |
| 6 <i>Rejoiceth not in iniquity, but rejoiceth in the truth;</i> | It does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth. |
| 7 <i>Beareth all things, believeth all things, hopeth all things, endureth all things.</i> | It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. |
| 8 <i>Charity never faileth: but whether there be prophecies, they shall fail; whether there be tongues, they shall cease; whether there be knowledge, it shall vanish away.</i> | Charity never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will cease; where there are tongues, they will be stilled; where there is knowledge, it will pass away. |
| 9 <i>For we know in part, and we prophesy in part.</i> | For we know in part and we prophesy in part, |
| 10 <i>But when that which is perfect is come, then that which is in part shall be done away.</i> | but when the perfect comes, the partial will be done away. |
| 11 <i>When I was a child, I spake as a child, I understood as a child, I thought as a child: but when I became a man, I put away childish things.</i> | When I was a child, I talked like a child, I thought like a child, I reasoned like a child. When I became a man, I put childish ways behind me. |
| 12 <i>For now we see through a glass, darkly; but then face to face: now I know in part; but then shall I know even as also I am known.</i> | Now we see through a glass, darkly — but then face to face. Now I know in part; but then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known. |

- 13
- And now abideth faith, hope, charity, these three; but the greatest of these is charity.*

And now these three remain: faith, hope, and charity. But the greatest of these is charity.

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Tim 1:5; 1 Pet 4:8; Gal 5:22; 1 Cor 13:8; Gal 5:6
- v2 — 1 John 4:8; 1 Cor 13:3; 1 John 4:20-21; Matt 17:20; Matt 21:21
- v3 — Jas 2:14-17; John 15:13; Matt 23:5; Matt 6:1-4; Matt 7:22-23
- v4 — 1 Pet 4:8; Eph 4:32; Gal 5:21-22; Prov 10:12; Col 3:12
- v5 — 1 Cor 10:24; Phil 2:3-5; 1 John 3:16-17; Jas 1:19; Phil 2:21
- v6 — Rom 12:9; 3 John 1:3-4; 2 John 1:4; Rom 1:32; 2 Thess 2:12
- v7 — 1 Pet 4:8; 1 Cor 13:4; 1 Pet 2:24; 2 Tim 2:24; Prov 10:12
- v8 — 1 Cor 13:13; 1 Cor 13:1-2; Gal 5:6; 1 Cor 13:10; Acts 2:4
- v9 — Col 2:2-3; Eph 3:18-19; 1 Cor 2:9; Ps 139:6; 1 Cor 13:12
- v11 — 1 Cor 14:20; 1 Cor 3:1-2; Gal 4:1; Eccl 11:10
- v12 — 1 John 3:2; 2 Cor 3:18; 1 Cor 13:9-10; Phil 3:12; Rev 22:4
- v13 — 1 Cor 16:14; Col 3:14; 1 John 4:7-18; 1 Cor 13:1-8; Gal 5:6

Chapter 14

Paul teaches that prophecy is greater than tongues in the assembly because it edifies the church, while tongues without interpretation edify only the speaker. He instructs that all things in worship must be done decently and in order, with no more than two or three speaking in tongues, and each in turn with an interpreter.

- 1

Follow after charity, and desire spiritual gifts, but rather that ye may prophesy.

Pursue charity, and eagerly desire spiritual gifts, especially prophecy.
- 2

For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries.

For anyone who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men but to God. No one understands him — he utters mysteries in the Spirit.
- 3

But he that prophesieth speaketh unto men to edification, and exhortation, and comfort.

But the one who prophesies speaks to people for their strengthening, encouragement, and comfort.

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| 4 | <i>He that speaketh in an unknown tongue edifieth himself; but he that prophesieth edifieth the church.</i> | The one who speaks in a tongue builds himself up, but the one who prophesies builds up the church. |
| 5 | <i>I would that ye all spake with tongues, but rather that ye prophesied: for greater is he that prophesieth than he that speaketh with tongues, except he interpret, that the church may receive edifying.</i> | I would like every one of you to speak in tongues, but I would rather have You prophesy. The one who prophesies is greater than the one who speaks in tongues, unless he also interprets, so that the church may be built up. |
| 6 | <i>Now, brethren, if I come unto you speaking with tongues, what shall I profit you, except I shall speak to you either by revelation, or by knowledge, or by prophesying, or by doctrine?</i> | Now, brothers, if I come to You speaking in tongues, what good will I be to You unless I bring some revelation or knowledge or prophecy or teaching? |
| 7 | <i>And even things without life giving sound, whether pipe or harp, except they give a distinction in the sounds, how shall it be known what is piped or harped?</i> | Even lifeless instruments, like the flute or harp, must give distinct notes — otherwise how will anyone know what is being played? |
| 8 | <i>For if the trumpet give an uncertain sound, who shall prepare himself to the battle?</i> | If the trumpet does not sound a clear call, who will get ready for battle? |
| 9 | <i>So likewise ye, except ye utter by the tongue words easy to be understood, how shall it be known what is spoken? for ye shall speak into the air.</i> | So it is with You. Unless You speak words that can be understood, how will anyone know what you are saying? You will just be speaking into the air. |
| 10 | <i>There are, it may be, so many kinds of voices in the world, and none of them is without signification.</i> | Undoubtedly there are all sorts of languages in the world, yet none of them is without meaning. |
| 11 | <i>Therefore if I know not the meaning of the voice, I shall be unto him that speaketh a barbarian, and he that speaketh shall be a barbarian unto me.</i> | If then I do not understand the meaning of what someone is saying, I will be a foreigner to the speaker and the speaker will be a foreigner to me. |

- 12 *Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual gifts, seek that ye may excel to the edifying of the church.* So it is with You. Since You are eager for spiritual gifts, try to excel in those that build up the church.
- 13 *Wherefore let him that speaketh in an unknown tongue pray that he may interpret.* For this reason, the one who speaks in a tongue should pray that he may interpret what He says.
- 14 *For if I pray in an unknown tongue, my spirit prayeth, but my understanding is unfruitful.* If I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my mind is unfruitful.
- 15 *What is it then? I will pray with the spirit, and I will pray with the understanding also: I will sing with the spirit, and I will sing with the understanding also.* So what shall I do? I will pray with my spirit, but I will also pray with my mind. I will sing with my spirit, but I will also sing with my mind.
- 16 *Else when thou shalt bless with the spirit, how shall he that occupieth the room of the unlearned say Amen at thy giving of thanks, seeing he understandeth not what thou sayest?* Otherwise, if You are praising God in the spirit, how can someone who does not understand say "Amen" to your thanksgiving? He does not know what You are saying.
- 17 *For thou verily givest thanks well, but the other is not edified.* You may be giving thanks very well, but the other person is not built up.
- 18 *I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all:* I thank God that I speak in tongues more than all of You.
- 19 *Yet in the church I had rather speak five words with my understanding, that by my voice I might teach others also, than ten thousand words in an unknown tongue.* But in the church I would rather speak five words with my mind to instruct others than ten thousand words in a tongue.
- 20 *Brethren, be not children in understanding: howbeit in malice be ye children, but in understanding be men.* Brothers, do not be childish in Your thinking. Be infants in evil, but in Your thinking be mature.

- 21 *In the law it is written, With men of other tongues and other lips will I speak unto this people; and yet for all that will they not hear me, saith the Lord.* In the law it is written: "With people of strange tongues and other lips I will speak to this people, and even then they will not hear Me, says the Lord."
- 22 *Wherefore tongues are for a sign, not to them that believe, but to them that believe not: but prophesying serveth not for them that believe not, but for them which believe.* So then tongues are a sign, not for believers but for unbelievers. Prophecy, however, is for believers, not unbelievers.
- 23 *If therefore the whole church be come together into one place, and all speak with tongues, and there come in those that are unlearned, or unbelievers, will they not say that ye are mad?* So if the whole church comes together and everyone speaks in tongues, and some who do not understand or some unbelievers come in, will they not say that You are out of Your minds?
- 24 *But if all prophesy, and there come in one that believeth not, or one unlearned, he is convinced of all, he is judged of all:* But if an unbeliever or someone who does not understand comes in while everyone is prophesying, He will be convicted by all and judged by all.
- 25 *And thus are the secrets of his heart made manifest; and so falling down on his face he will worship God, and report that God is in you of a truth.* The secrets of His heart will be revealed. He will fall down and worship God, declaring, "God is truly among You."
- 26 *How is it then, brethren? when ye come together, every one of you hath a psalm, hath a doctrine, hath a tongue, hath a revelation, hath an interpretation. Let all things be done unto edifying.* What then shall we say, brothers? When You come together, each one has a hymn, a teaching, a revelation, a tongue, or an interpretation. Everything must be done to build up the church.
- 27 *If any man speak in an unknown tongue, let it be by two, or at the most by three, and that by course; and let one interpret.* If anyone speaks in a tongue, two — or at most three — should speak, one at a time, and someone must interpret.

- 28 *But if there be no interpreter, let him keep silence in the church; and let him speak to himself, and to God.* If there is no interpreter, the speaker should keep quiet in the church and speak to Himself and to God.
- 29 *Let the prophets speak two or three, and let the other judge.* Two or three prophets should speak, and the others should weigh carefully what is said.
- 30 *If any thing be revealed to another that sitteth by, let the first hold his peace.* And if a revelation comes to someone who is sitting down, the first speaker should stop.
- 31 *For ye may all prophesy one by one, that all may learn, and all may be comforted.* For You can all prophesy in turn so that everyone may learn and be encouraged.
- 32 *And the spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets.* The spirits of the prophets are subject to the control of prophets.
- 33 *For God is not the author of confusion, but of peace, as in all churches of the saints.* For God is not a God of disorder but of peace — as in all the churches of the saints.
- 34 *Let your women keep silence in the churches: for it is not permitted unto them to speak; but they are commanded to be under obedience, as also saith the law.* Let Your women keep silence in the churches, for it is not permitted to them to speak; but they are commanded to be under obedience, as also says the law.
- 35 *And if they will learn any thing, let them ask their husbands at home: for it is a shame for women to speak in the church.* If they want to inquire about something, they should ask their own husbands at home. It is shameful for a woman to speak in the church.
- 36 *What? came the word of God out from you? or came it unto you only?* Did the word of God originate with You? Or are You the only people it has reached?
- 37 *If any man think himself to be a prophet, or spiritual, let him acknowledge that the things that I write unto you are the commandments of the Lord.* If anyone thinks he is a prophet or spiritual, let him acknowledge that what I am writing to You is the Lord's command.

38	<i>But if any man be ignorant, let him be ignorant.</i>	If anyone ignores this, he will be ignored.
39	<i>Wherefore, brethren, covet to prophesy, and forbid not to speak with tongues.</i>	Therefore, my brothers, be eager to prophesy, and do not forbid speaking in tongues.
40	<i>Let all things be done decently and in order.</i>	But everything should be done in a proper and orderly way.

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Tim 4:14; 1 Cor 14:39; 1 Cor 16:14; 1 Cor 12:1; 1 Thess 5:20
- v2 — Mark 16:17; Acts 10:46; Acts 19:6; Acts 2:4-11; 1 Cor 13:2
- v3 — 1 Tim 4:13; 1 Cor 14:12; Jude 1:20; 2 Tim 4:2; Eph 6:22
- v4 — 1 Cor 14:22; 1 Cor 14:26; Mark 16:17
- v15 — Col 3:16; Eph 6:18; Eph 5:17-20; John 4:23-24; Jude 1:20
- v20 — 1 Pet 2:2; 1 Cor 13:11; Rom 16:19; Matt 18:3; Eph 4:14-15
- v21 — Isa 28:11-12; Jer 5:15; Deut 28:49
- v26 — Eph 5:19; 1 Cor 12:7-10; Rom 14:19; 1 Thess 5:11; Eph 4:16
- v33 — Jas 3:17-18; 1 Cor 14:40; 2 Thess 3:16; Gal 5:22; 1 Cor 11:16
- v34 — 1 Tim 2:11-12; Gen 3:16; Num 30:3-13; 1 Cor 14:35; Col 3:18
- v37 — 1 John 4:6; 2 Cor 10:7; Jude 1:17; 2 Pet 3:2
- v40 — Titus 1:5; Col 2:5; 1 Cor 14:26-33; Rom 13:13; 1 Cor 11:34

Chapter 15

Paul declares the gospel: that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again the third day according to the scriptures, and appeared to more than five hundred brethren. He argues that if Christ is not risen then faith is vain, but now Christ is risen and become the firstfruits of them that slept. He reveals the mystery that at the last trumpet the dead shall be raised incorruptible and death shall be swallowed up in victory.

1	<i>Moreover, brethren, I declare unto you the gospel which I preached unto you, which also ye have received, and wherein ye stand;</i>	Now, brothers, I want to remind You of the gospel I preached to You, which You received and on which You have taken Your stand.
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| <p>2 <i>By which also ye are saved, if ye keep in memory what I preached unto you, unless ye have believed in vain.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For I delivered unto you first of all that which I also received, how that Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures;</i></p> <p>4 <i>And that he was buried, and that he rose again the third day according to the scriptures:</i></p> <p>5 <i>And that he was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve:</i></p> <p>6 <i>After that, he was seen of above five hundred brethren at once; of whom the greater part remain unto this present, but some are fallen asleep.</i></p> <p>7 <i>After that, he was seen of James; then of all the apostles.</i></p> <p>8 <i>And last of all he was seen of me also, as of one born out of due time.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For I am the least of the apostles, that am not meet to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God.</i></p> <p>10 <i>But by the grace of God I am what I am: and his grace which was bestowed upon me was not in vain; but I laboured more abundantly than they all: yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Therefore whether it were I or they, so we preach, and so ye believed.</i></p> | <p>By this gospel You are saved, if You hold firmly to the word I preached to You — otherwise You have believed in vain.</p> <p>For what I received I passed on to You as of first importance: that Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures,</p> <p>that He was buried, that He was raised on the third day according to the scriptures,</p> <p>and that He appeared to Cephas, and then to the Twelve.</p> <p>After that, He appeared to more than five hundred brothers at the same time, most of whom are still living, though some have fallen asleep.</p> <p>Then He appeared to James, then to all the apostles.</p> <p>Last of all He appeared to me also, as to one born out of due time.</p> <p>For I am the least of the apostles, not fit to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God.</p> <p>But by the grace of God I am what I am. His grace to me was not without effect. I worked harder than all of them — yet not I, but the grace of God that was with me.</p> <p>Whether, then, it was I or they, this is what we preach, and this is what You believed.</p> |
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- 12 *Now if Christ be preached that he rose from the dead, how say some among you that there is no resurrection of the dead?* But if it is preached that Christ has been raised from the dead, how can some of You say that there is no resurrection of the dead?
- 13 *But if there be no resurrection of the dead, then is Christ not risen:* If there is no resurrection of the dead, then not even Christ has been raised.
- 14 *And if Christ be not risen, then is our preaching vain, and your faith is also vain.* And if Christ has not been raised, our preaching is useless and so is Your faith.
- 15 *Yea, and we are found false witnesses of God; because we have testified of God that he raised up Christ: whom he raised not up, if so be that the dead rise not.* More than that, we are then found to be false witnesses about God, for we have testified about God that He raised Christ from the dead. But He did not raise Him if in fact the dead are not raised.
- 16 *For if the dead rise not, then is not Christ raised:* For if the dead are not raised, then Christ has not been raised either.
- 17 *And if Christ be not raised, your faith is vain; ye are yet in your sins.* And if Christ has not been raised, Your faith is futile; You are still in Your sins.
- 18 *Then they also which are fallen asleep in Christ are perished.* Then also those who have fallen asleep in Christ are lost.
- 19 *If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable.* If only for this life we have hope in Christ, we are of all people most to be pitied.
- 20 *But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.* But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep.
- 21 *For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead.* For since death came through a man, the resurrection of the dead also comes through a man.
- 22 *For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.* For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all will be quickened.

- 23 *But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ's at his coming.* But each in His own order: Christ the firstfruits, then at His coming those who belong to Christ.
- 24 *Then cometh the end, when he shall have delivered up the kingdom to God, even the Father; when he shall have put down all rule and all authority and power.* Then comes the end, when He delivers the kingdom to God the Father after destroying every rule and every authority and power.
- 25 *For he must reign, till he hath put all enemies under his feet.* For He must reign until He has put all His enemies under His feet.
- 26 *The last enemy that shall be destroyed is death.* The last enemy to be destroyed is death.
- 27 *For he hath put all things under his feet. But when he saith all things are put under him, it is manifest that he is excepted, which did put all things under him.* For He has put everything under His feet. Now when it says that everything has been put under Him, it is clear that this does not include God Himself, who put everything under Christ.
- 28 *And when all things shall be subdued unto him, then shall the Son also himself be subject unto him that put all things under him, that God may be all in all.* When all things have been subjected to Him, then the Son Himself will also be subject to the One who put everything under him, so that God may be all in all.
- 29 *Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?* Now if there is no resurrection, what will those do who are baptized for the dead? If the dead are not raised at all, why are people baptized for them?
- 30 *And why stand we in jeopardy every hour?* And why do we endanger ourselves every hour?
- 31 *I protest by your rejoicing which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die daily.* I face death every day — as surely as I boast about You in Christ Jesus our Lord.

- 32 *If after the manner of men I have fought with beasts at Ephesus, what advantageth it me, if the dead rise not? let us eat and drink; for to morrow we die.* If I fought wild beasts at Ephesus with nothing more than human motives, what have I gained? If the dead are not raised, "Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die."
- 33 *Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners.* Do not be misled: "Bad company corrupts good character."
- 34 *Awake to righteousness, and sin not; for some have not the knowledge of God: I speak this to your shame.* Come back to Your senses and stop sinning. Some people are ignorant of God — I say this to Your shame.
- 35 *But some man will say, How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come?* But someone will ask, "How are the dead raised? With what kind of body will they come?"
- 36 *Thou fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die:* How foolish! What You sow does not come to life unless it dies.
- 37 *And that which thou sowest, thou sowest not that body that shall be, but bare grain, it may chance of wheat, or of some other grain:* When You sow, You do not plant the body that will be, but just a seed — perhaps wheat or something else.
- 38 *But God giveth it a body as it hath pleased him, and to every seed his own body.* But God gives it a body as He has determined, and to each kind of seed its own body.
- 39 *All flesh is not the same flesh: but there is one kind of flesh of men, another flesh of beasts, another of fishes, and another of birds.* Not all flesh is the same: people have one kind, animals have another, birds another, and fish another.
- 40 *There are also celestial bodies, and bodies terrestrial: but the glory of the celestial is one, and the glory of the terrestrial is another.* There are heavenly bodies and earthly bodies, but the glory of the heavenly bodies is different from that of the earthly bodies.
- 41 *There is one glory of the sun, and another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars: for one star differeth from another star in glory.* The sun has one kind of glory, the moon another, and the stars another. And star differs from star in glory.

- 42 *So also is the resurrection of the dead. It is sown in corruption; it is raised in incorruption:* So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. What is sown is perishable; what is raised is imperishable.
- 43 *It is sown in dishonour; it is raised in glory: it is sown in weakness; it is raised in power:* It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power.
- 44 *It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body, and there is a spiritual body.* It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body.
- 45 *And so it is written, The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.* So it is written: "The first man Adam became a living soul." The last Adam became a quickening spirit.
- 46 *Howbeit that was not first which is spiritual, but that which is natural; and afterward that which is spiritual.* The spiritual did not come first, but the natural, and after that the spiritual.
- 47 *The first man is of the earth, earthy: the second man is the Lord from heaven.* The first man was from the earth — earthy. The second man is the Lord from heaven.
- 48 *As is the earthy, such are they also that are earthy: and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly.* As was the man from the earth, so also are those who are of the earth. As is the Man from heaven, so also are those who are of heaven.
- 49 *And as we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly.* Just as we have borne the image of the man of earth, we will also bear the image of the Man from heaven.
- 50 *Now this I say, brethren, that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God; neither doth corruption inherit incorruption.* I declare to you, brothers, that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God; neither does corruption inherit incorruption.
- 51 *Behold, I shew you a mystery; We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed,* Listen, I tell you a mystery: we will not all sleep, but we will all be changed—

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| 52 | <i>In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump: for the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.</i> | in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. The trumpet will sound, the dead will be raised imperishable, and we will be changed. |
| 53 | <i>For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality.</i> | For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality. |
| 54 | <i>So when this corruptible shall have put on incorruption, and this mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written, Death is swallowed up in victory.</i> | So when this corruptible has put on incorruption, and this mortal has put on immortality, then shall come to pass the saying that is written: "Death is swallowed up in victory." |
| 55 | <i>O death, where is thy sting? O grave, where is thy victory?</i> | "Where, O death, is your victory? Where, O death, is your sting?" |
| 56 | <i>The sting of death is sin; and the strength of sin is the law.</i> | The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. |
| 57 | <i>But thanks be to God, which giveth us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | But thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 58 | <i>Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.</i> | Therefore, my dear brothers, stand firm. Let nothing move You. Always give yourselves fully to the work of the Lord, knowing that Your labor in the Lord is not in vain. |

Words in this chapter:

quicken — Made alive — spiritually brought from death to life by God; used for resurrection and spiritual rebirth.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Cross-References:

- v3 — 1 Pet 2:24; Gal 1:4; Isa 53:1-12; 1 John 2:2; Gal 1:12
- v4 — Hos 6:2; Matt 12:40; Ps 16:10-11; Acts 13:29-37; Isa 53:9-12
- v10 — Phil 4:13; Phil 2:13; 2 Cor 3:5; Eph 3:7-8; Eph 2:7-8
- v20 — Acts 26:23; 1 Cor 15:23; Rev 1:5; 1 Pet 1:3; Col 1:18
- v26 — 2 Tim 1:10; Rev 21:4; 1 Cor 15:55; Rev 20:14; Isa 25:8
- v33 — Prov 13:20; Matt 24:4; 1 Cor 5:6; Prov 9:6; Eph 5:6
- v45 — John 5:21; Gen 2:7; Rom 8:2; Rom 8:10-11; Rom 5:12-14
- v52 — 1 Thess 4:16-17; Matt 24:31; John 5:28; John 5:25; Isa 27:13
- v54 — Isa 25:8; Rev 21:4; Rev 20:14; Heb 2:14-15; Luke 20:36
- v55 — Hos 13:14; Ps 89:48; Rom 5:14; Acts 2:27; Ps 49:8-15
- v57 — 2 Cor 2:14; Rom 8:37; 1 John 5:4-5; Prov 21:31; Rev 12:11
- v58 — Gal 6:9; 2 Chr 15:7; Heb 6:10; Phil 2:16; 1 Cor 3:8

Chapter 16

Paul gives instructions for the collection for the saints in Jerusalem, directing each person to set aside something on the first day of the week. He outlines his travel plans, commends Timothy and Apollos to them, and closes with exhortations to watch, stand fast in the faith, and let all things be done with charity.

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| 1 <i>Now concerning the collection for the saints, as I have given order to the churches of Galatia, even so do ye.</i> | Now concerning the collection for the saints: as I directed the churches of Galatia, so you also are to do. |
| 2 <i>Upon the first day of the week let every one of you lay by him in store, as God hath prospered him, that there be no gatherings when I come.</i> | On the first day of every week, each of you is to put something aside and save it up, as he may prosper, so that there will be no collections when I come. |
| 3 <i>And when I come, whomsoever ye shall approve by your letters, them will I send to bring your liberality unto Jerusalem.</i> | When I arrive, I will send those whom you have approved with letters to carry your gift to Jerusalem. |
| 4 <i>And if it be meet that I go also, they shall go with me.</i> | If it seems worth my going also, they will go with me. |

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| 5 | <i>Now I will come unto you, when I shall pass through Macedonia: for I do pass through Macedonia.</i> | I will visit you after passing through Macedonia, for I intend to pass through Macedonia. |
| 6 | <i>And it may be that I will abide, yea, and winter with you, that ye may bring me on my journey whithersoever I go.</i> | Perhaps I will stay with you or even spend the winter, so that you can help me on my journey to wherever I go. |
| 7 | <i>For I will not see you now by the way; but I trust to tarry a while with you, if the Lord permit.</i> | I do not want to see you now just in passing. I hope to spend some time with you, if the Lord permits. |
| 8 | <i>But I will tarry at Ephesus until Pentecost.</i> | But I will stay in Ephesus until Pentecost, |
| 9 | <i>For a great door and effectual is opened unto me, and there are many adversaries.</i> | for a wide and effective door has opened to me, and there are many who oppose me. |
| 10 | <i>Now if Timotheus come, see that he may be with you without fear: for he worketh the work of the Lord, as I also do.</i> | When Timothy comes, see to it that he is at ease among you, for he is doing the work of the Lord just as I am. |
| 11 | <i>Let no man therefore despise him: but conduct him forth in peace, that he may come unto me: for I look for him with the brethren.</i> | So let no one look down on him. Send him on his way in peace so that he may return to me, for I am expecting him with the brothers. |
| 12 | <i>As touching our brother Apollos, I greatly desired him to come unto you with the brethren: but his will was not at all to come at this time; but he will come when he shall have convenient time.</i> | Now regarding our brother Apollos: I strongly urged him to visit you with the brothers, but it was not at all his will to come now. He will come when he has opportunity. |
| 13 | <i>Watch ye, stand fast in the faith, quit you like men, be strong.</i> | Watch, stand fast in the faith, quit you like men, be strong. |
| 14 | <i>Let all your things be done with charity.</i> | Do everything in charity. |

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| <p>15 <i>I beseech you, brethren, (ye know the house of Stephanas, that it is the firstfruits of Achaia, and that they have addicted themselves to the ministry of the saints,)</i></p> <p>16 <i>That ye submit yourselves unto such, and to every one that helpeth with us, and laboureth.</i></p> <p>17 <i>I am glad of the coming of Stephanas and Fortunatus and Achaicus: for that which was lacking on your part they have supplied.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For they have refreshed my spirit and yours: therefore acknowledge ye them that are such.</i></p> <p>19 <i>The churches of Asia salute you. Aquila and Priscilla salute you much in the Lord, with the church that is in their house.</i></p> <p>20 <i>All the brethren greet you. Greet ye one another with an holy kiss.</i></p> <p>21 <i>The salutation of me Paul with mine own hand.</i></p> <p>22 <i>If any man love not the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be Anathema Maranatha.</i></p> <p>23 <i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.</i></p> <p>24 <i>My love be with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen.</i></p> | <p>You know that the household of Stephanas were the firstfruits of Achaia and that they devoted themselves to the service of the saints. I urge you, brothers—</p> <p>to submit to such men and to everyone who works and labors with them.</p> <p>I am glad about the coming of Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus, because they have supplied what was lacking from you.</p> <p>They refreshed my spirit as well as yours. Give recognition to such men.</p> <p>The churches of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you warmly in the Lord, and so does the church that meets at their house.</p> <p>All the brothers here send you greetings. Greet one another with a holy kiss.</p> <p>I, Paul, write this greeting in my own hand.</p> <p>If anyone does not love the Lord, let him be cursed. Come, Lord!</p> <p>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with You.</p> <p>My love be with all of You in Christ Jesus. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Maranatha (*mah-rah-NAH-thah*) — Aramaic phrase meaning 'Our Lord, come!' — a prayer for Christ's return, used in early Christian worship.

Pentecost (*PEN-teh-cost*) — The Feast of Weeks — celebrated fifty days after Passover; the harvest festival; in the NT, the day the Holy Spirit came on the early church.

Aquila (*AK-wih-lah*) — A Jewish tent-maker from Pontus who worked and traveled with Paul — expelled from Rome by Emperor Claudius; husband of Priscilla; his name means 'eagle.'

Priscilla (*prih-SIL-ah*) — Wife of Aquila, a tent-maker couple who hosted a church in their home — worked with Paul and taught Apollos; her name is a Latin diminutive of Prisca ('ancient').

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

v1 — 2 Cor 8:1-9; 2 Cor 9:12-15; 1 John 3:17; Rom 12:13; Gal 2:10

v2 — Mal 3:9-10; Acts 20:7; Luke 16:10; Deut 8:18; Deut 15:11-14

v7 — Acts 18:21; Jas 4:15; 1 Cor 4:19

v9 — 2 Cor 2:12; Acts 14:27; Col 4:3; Rev 3:7-8; 2 Cor 1:8-10

v11 — 1 Tim 4:12; Titus 2:15; Acts 15:33

v13 — Josh 1:9; Eph 6:13-18; Eph 6:10; 1 Cor 15:58; 2 Cor 12:9-10

v14 — John 13:34-35; 1 Pet 4:8; 1 Tim 1:5; 1 John 4:7-8; 1 Cor 12:31-14:1

v15 — 1 Cor 1:16; Rom 16:5

v16 — 1 Thess 5:12; Heb 13:17

v18 — Phlm 1:7; 2 Cor 7:13; Rom 15:32

v21 — Gal 6:11; Col 4:18; 2 Thess 3:17

v22 — Eph 6:24; John 14:21; 1 John 4:19; 1 John 5:1; Heb 6:10

2 Corinthians

Author: Paul the apostle — he names himself in 1:1 and 10:1, and writes with great emotional intensity from beginning to end. Timothy joins him in the greeting (1:1) but Paul is plainly the author.

Date written: c. AD 56, from somewhere in Macedonia, during Paul's third missionary journey. The letter was written between 1 Corinthians and Romans.

> ■ **NAME NOTE** — **Paul** (PAWL) — "small, humble" — Born Saul of Tarsus; a Pharisee and persecutor of the early church who was confronted by the risen Christ on the road to Damascus and became the great apostle to the Gentiles. He founded the Corinthian church on his second missionary journey (Acts 18) and wrote them at least four letters, of which 1 and 2 Corinthians survive.

> ■ **NAME NOTE** — **Corinth** (KOR-inth) — A wealthy Greek seaport on the narrow isthmus joining mainland Greece to the Peloponnese; the commercial capital of southern Greece. Famous for its luxury, two harbors, the temple of Aphrodite, and notorious sexual immorality. Paul spent a year and a half there founding the church (Acts 18) and to it he addressed both Corinthian epistles.

Written to: The church at Corinth, the wealthy Greek port city Paul had founded on his second missionary journey (Acts 18), and to which he had already written 1 Corinthians.

Setting: After 1 Corinthians, Paul made a brief "painful visit" to Corinth (2:1) and then wrote a "severe letter" (2:3–4; 7:8) calling the church to discipline a particular sinner. Titus carried that letter and returned to Paul in Macedonia with the news that the church had repented and disciplined the offender. Greatly relieved, Paul wrote 2 Corinthians — partly to express his joy at their repentance and his pastoral love for them; partly to defend his apostolic authority against rival "super-apostles" (11:5; 12:11) who had infiltrated Corinth; and partly to organize the offering for the suffering saints in Jerusalem (chs. 8–9).

Where this sits historically: Written from Macedonia under Nero (c. AD 56), shortly after Paul had been driven out of Ephesus by the silversmiths' riot (Acts 19) and only a year before he carried the Jerusalem collection to Judea.

Contemporaries: Titus, Timothy, Luke, and Silas were Paul's coworkers in Macedonia at this time, while Peter ministered eastward and James continued to lead the Jerusalem church awaiting Paul's relief offering.

Big themes: the comfort of God in tribulation (1:3–11); the new covenant ministry of glory (ch. 3); treasure in earthen vessels (ch. 4); the ministry of reconciliation (5:11–21); generosity in giving (chs. 8–9); the defense of Paul's apostleship against false apostles (chs. 10–13); Paul's "thorn in the flesh" and the sufficiency of grace (12:7–10); the Trinitarian benediction (13:14).

Key passages: 2 Corinthians 1:3–4; 3:18; 4:7–10; 4:17–18; 5:17–21; 8:9; 9:6–8; 12:9–10; 13:14.

How it fits: 2 Corinthians is the most personal and emotional of Paul's letters. It is the chief NT text on Christian suffering and comfort, on the new covenant ministry, on substitutionary atonement (5:21), and on the principles of Christian giving. The Trinitarian benediction in 13:14 is the most explicit Trinitarian formula in the New Testament.

Chapter 1

Paul blesses God as the Father of mercies and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our tribulation so that we may comfort others. He defends his sincerity toward the Corinthians and explains that he delayed his visit not out of fickleness but to spare them pain.

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Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, and Timothy our brother, unto the church of God which is at Corinth, with all the saints which are in all Achaia:

From Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, and from Timothy our brother — to the church of God which is at Corinth, together with all the saints throughout Achaia:

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Timothy** (TIM-uh-thee) — also **Timotheus** in older KJV spelling — "honoring God" — Paul's beloved younger co-worker; the son of a Jewish-Christian mother (Eunice) and a Greek father. Paul met him at Lystra on the second missionary journey (Acts 16:1–3) and treated him almost as a son in the faith. Paul wrote him two personal letters (1 and 2 Timothy).

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Achaia** (uh-KAY-yuh) — The Roman province covering southern Greece, including Corinth and Athens; Corinth was its capital. When Paul addresses "all the saints in all Achaia" he includes the believers in surrounding towns who looked to the Corinthian church.

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Grace be to you and peace from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

Grace and peace to You from God our Father and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Every time Paul opens a letter with "grace and peace," he is reminding you that everything God does for you comes freely, out of His love alone.

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Blessed be God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies, and the God of all comfort;

Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and the God of all comfort,

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| <p>4 <i>Who comforteth us in all our tribulation, that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble, by the comfort wherewith we ourselves are comforted of God.</i></p> <p>5 <i>For as the sufferings of Christ abound in us, so our consolation also aboundeth by Christ.</i></p> <p>6 <i>And whether we be afflicted, it is for your consolation and salvation, which is effectual in the enduring of the same sufferings which we also suffer: or whether we be comforted, it is for your consolation and salvation.</i></p> <p>7 <i>And our hope of you is steadfast, knowing, that as ye are partakers of the sufferings, so shall ye be also of the consolation.</i></p> | <p>who comforts us in all our tribulation, so that we are able to comfort those who are in any kind of trouble, with the same comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God.</p> <p>For just as the sufferings of Christ overflow into our lives, so also through Christ our consolation overflows.</p> <p>If we are afflicted, it is for Your consolation and salvation, which is at work as You patiently endure the same sufferings that we also suffer. And if we are comforted, it is for Your consolation and salvation.</p> <p>And our hope for You is steadfast, because we know that as You share in the sufferings, so also You will share in the consolation.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Mercy* (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God's mercy means He withholds the wrath we have earned. It is not the same as grace (which gives good things we don't deserve) — mercy holds back the punishment we do deserve.

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| <p>8 <i>For we would not, brethren, have you ignorant of our trouble which came to us in Asia, that we were pressed out of measure, above strength, insomuch that we despaired even of life:</i></p> | <p>Brothers, we do not want You to be unaware of the trouble we faced in Asia. We were pressed beyond measure, beyond our own strength, so that we despaired even of life itself.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — *Asia* (AY-zuh) — The Roman province on the western coast of modern-day Turkey, with Ephesus as its capital. This is not the whole continent but the region where Paul had ministered for nearly three years (Acts 19). The "trouble in Asia" likely refers to the riot at Ephesus or to some other near-death affliction Paul suffered there.

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| <p>9 <i>But we had the sentence of death in ourselves, that we should not trust in ourselves, but in God which raiseth the dead:</i></p> | <p>Indeed, we had the sentence of death in ourselves, so that we would not trust in ourselves, but in God Who raises the dead.</p> |
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- 10 *Who delivered us from so great a death, and doth deliver: in whom we trust that he will yet deliver us;* He delivered us from such a great death, and He still delivers us; in Him we have set our hope that He will yet deliver us,
- 11 *Ye also helping together by prayer for us, that for the gift bestowed upon us by the means of many persons thanks may be given by many on our behalf.* as You also help together by praying for us, so that thanks may be given by many people on our behalf for the gracious gift granted to us through the prayers of many.
- 12 *For our rejoicing is this, the testimony of our conscience, that in simplicity and godly sincerity, not with fleshly wisdom, but by the grace of God, we have had our conversation in the world, and more abundantly to you-ward.* Our boast is this: the testimony of our conscience that we have conducted ourselves in the world — and especially toward You — in simplicity and godly sincerity, not by fleshly wisdom but by the grace of God.
- 13 *For we write none other things unto you, than what ye read or acknowledge; and I trust ye shall acknowledge even to the end;* For we write nothing to You other than what You read and understand. And I hope You will understand it fully,
- 14 *As also ye have acknowledged us in part, that we are your rejoicing, even as ye also are ours in the day of the Lord Jesus.* just as You have understood us in part — that we are Your boast, even as You are ours, in the day of the Lord Jesus.
- 15 *And in this confidence I was minded to come unto you before, that ye might have a second benefit;* Because of this confidence, I planned to come to You first, so that You might have a double blessing:
- 16 *And to pass by you into Macedonia, and to come again out of Macedonia unto you, and of you to be brought on my way toward Judaea.* to pass through Your city on my way to Macedonia, then to come back to You from Macedonia, and have You send me on my way to Judaea.

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| <p>17 <i>When I therefore was thus minded, did I use lightness? or the things that I purpose, do I purpose according to the flesh, that with me there should be yea yea, and nay nay?</i></p> <p>18 <i>But as God is true, our word toward you was not yea and nay.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, who was preached among you by us, even by me and Silvanus and Timotheus, was not yea and nay; but in him was yea.</i></p> | <p>When I planned this, was I being fickle? Or do I make my plans according to the flesh, ready to say "yes, yes" and "no, no" in the same breath?</p> <p>But as surely as God is faithful, our word to You was not "yes" and "no."</p> <p>For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, Who was preached among You by us — by me and Silas and Timothy — was not "yes" and "no," but in him it has always been "yes."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — *Silas* (SY-lus) — also *Silvanus* in this verse — A leading member of the Jerusalem church (Acts 15:22); Paul's traveling companion through much of the second missionary journey, including the founding of the Corinthian church (Acts 18:5). *Silvanus* is the Latin form; *Silas* is the Greek shortened form used in Acts. Both refer to the same man.

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| <p>20 <i>For all the promises of God in him are yea, and in him Amen, unto the glory of God by us.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Now he which stablisheth us with you in Christ, and hath anointed us, is God;</i></p> <p>22 <i>Who hath also sealed us, and given the earnest of the Spirit in our hearts.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Moreover I call God for a record upon my soul, that to spare you I came not as yet unto Corinth.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Not for that we have dominion over your faith, but are helpers of your joy: for by faith ye stand.</i></p> | <p>For all the promises of God find their "yes" in Him, and through Him also our "Amen" is spoken, to the glory of God.</p> <p>Now it is God Who establishes us with You in Christ, and who has anointed us.</p> <p>He has also sealed us as His own, and has given us the earnest of the Spirit in our hearts as a pledge of what is to come.</p> <p>I call God as my witness — He sees my soul — that it was to spare You that I did not come to Corinth again.</p> <p>Not that we have dominion over Your faith — rather, we work together with You for Your joy, for it is by faith that You stand.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Eph 1:3; 1 Pet 1:3; Rom 15:5-6; Mic 7:18; Ps 86:5
- v4 — 1 Thess 5:11; Isa 51:12; 2 Thess 2:16-17; 2 Cor 7:6-7; Isa 40:1
- v5 — Col 1:24; Phil 3:10; Phil 1:20; 2 Thess 2:16-17; 2 Cor 4:10-11
- v7 — Rom 8:17-18; 2 Thess 1:4-7; Jas 1:12; 1 Thess 1:3-4; Jas 1:2-4
- v8 — 2 Cor 4:7-12; 1 Cor 15:32; 1 Cor 4:8; 1 Cor 16:9; Acts 19:23-35
- v9 — 2 Cor 3:5; Heb 11:19; 2 Cor 4:7; 2 Cor 12:7-10; Rom 4:17-25
- v10 — 1 Tim 4:10; Ps 34:19; 2 Pet 2:9; 1 Sam 17:37; 2 Tim 4:17
- v11 — Phil 1:19; 2 Cor 4:15; Acts 12:5; Col 4:3; Phlm 1:22
- v17 — Matt 5:37; Jas 5:12; 2 Cor 10:2-3; John 8:15; 2 Cor 1:18-20
- v20 — 1 John 2:24-25; Gal 3:22; Rev 7:12; Heb 13:8; Eph 1:6
- v21 — 1 John 2:27; 1 John 2:20; 1 Pet 5:10; Rom 8:9; Isa 61:1
- v22 — Eph 4:30; 2 Cor 5:5; Eph 1:13-14; John 6:27; Rev 9:4

Chapter 2

Paul explains that his earlier letter was written out of much affliction and tears, not to grieve them but so they would know his abundant love. He urges them to forgive and comfort the repentant offender, lest Satan gain an advantage, and describes the triumphal spread of the gospel as a sweet fragrance of Christ.

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| 1 | <i>But I determined this with myself, that I would not come again to you in heaviness.</i> | So I made up my mind not to make another painful visit to You. |
| 2 | <i>For if I make you sorry, who is he then that maketh me glad, but the same which is made sorry by me?</i> | For if I cause You grief, who is left to make me glad but the very one whom I have grieved? |
| 3 | <i>And I wrote this same unto you, lest, when I came, I should have sorrow from them of whom I ought to rejoice; having confidence in you all, that my joy is the joy of you all.</i> | And this is the very reason I wrote what I did — so that when I came I would not be saddened by those who ought to make me rejoice. I had confidence in You all, that my joy would be the joy of You all. |

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| <p>4 <i>For out of much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote unto you with many tears; not that ye should be grieved, but that ye might know the love which I have more abundantly unto you.</i></p> <p>5 <i>But if any have caused grief, he hath not grieved me, but in part: that I may not overcharge you all.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Sufficient to such a man is this punishment, which was inflicted of many.</i></p> <p>7 <i>So that contrariwise ye ought rather to forgive him, and comfort him, lest perhaps such a one should be swallowed up with overmuch sorrow.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Wherefore I beseech you that ye would confirm your love toward him.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For to this end also did I write, that I might know the proof of you, whether ye be obedient in all things.</i></p> <p>10 <i>To whom ye forgive any thing, I forgive also: for if I forgave any thing, to whom I forgave it, for your sakes forgave I it in the person of Christ;</i></p> <p>11 <i>Lest Satan should get an advantage of us: for we are not ignorant of his devices.</i></p> | <p>For out of much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote to You with many tears — not to grieve You, but to let You know the overflowing love I have for You.</p> <p>But if anyone has caused grief, he has not grieved me alone but in some measure all of You — I do not want to put the matter too heavily.</p> <p>The punishment imposed on Him by the majority is enough for such a man.</p> <p>So now You should rather forgive Him and comfort Him, or He may be overwhelmed by too much sorrow.</p> <p>So I appeal to You to reaffirm Your love for Him.</p> <p>This is the very reason I wrote — to put You to the test and see whether You would be obedient in everything.</p> <p>Anyone you forgive, I also forgive. And what I have forgiven — if I have forgiven anything — I have forgiven for Your sakes in the presence of Christ,</p> <p>so that Satan would not gain the advantage over us — for we are not ignorant of his devices.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Satan** (SAY-tun) — "the adversary, the accuser" — *The fallen angel who opposes God and tempts and accuses God's people. Paul's warning here is sober: the devil exploits unforgiveness in a church to divide and destroy it.*

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| 12 <i>Furthermore, when I came to Troas to preach Christ's gospel, and a door was opened unto me of the Lord,</i> | When I came to Troas to preach the gospel of Christ, the Lord had opened a door for me there. |
| 13 <i>I had no rest in my spirit, because I found not Titus my brother: but taking my leave of them, I went from thence into Macedonia.</i> | But I had no rest in my spirit, because I did not find my brother Titus there. So I took my leave of them and went on into Macedonia. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Titus** (TY-tus) — A Greek convert and trusted co-worker of Paul; one of his most reliable troubleshooters. Paul sent him to Corinth with the "severe letter" and waited anxiously in Macedonia for his return (2:13; 7:6–7, 13–15). Paul later left him to organize the church on Crete, and addressed the epistle to Titus to him there.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Macedonia** (mas-eh-DO-nee-ah) — A Roman province in northern Greece. Paul received the famous "Macedonian vision" in Acts 16 calling him to bring the gospel into Europe; from it came the churches at Philippi, Thessalonica, and Berea. Paul is writing this letter from somewhere in Macedonia, probably Philippi.

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| 14 <i>Now thanks be unto God, which always causeth us to triumph in Christ, and maketh manifest the savour of his knowledge by us in every place.</i> | But thanks be to God, Who always leads us in triumph in Christ and through us spreads the fragrance of the knowledge of Him everywhere. |
| 15 <i>For we are unto God a sweet savour of Christ, in them that are saved, and in them that perish:</i> | For we are to God the sweet aroma of Christ among those who are being saved and among those who are perishing. |
| 16 <i>To the one we are the savour of death unto death; and to the other the savour of life unto life. And who is sufficient for these things?</i> | To the one we are an aroma of death leading to death, and to the other an aroma of life leading to life. And who is sufficient for such things? |
| 17 <i>For we are not as many, which corrupt the word of God: but as of sincerity, but as of God, in the sight of God speak we in Christ.</i> | For we are not like so many, who peddle the word of God for profit. On the contrary, in Christ we speak before God with sincerity, as men sent from God. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3 — Gal 5:10; Phlm 1:21; 2 Cor 8:22
- v4 — 2 Cor 7:12; Prov 27:5-6; Lev 19:17-18
- v6 — 1 Cor 5:4-5; 1 Tim 5:20
- v7 — Eph 4:32; Gal 6:1-2; Col 3:13
- v10 — John 20:23; 2 Cor 5:20
- v11 — 1 Pet 5:8; Eph 6:11-12; 2 Cor 11:3; Luke 22:31; 2 Cor 4:4
- v12 — Acts 16:8; Acts 14:27; Col 4:3
- v13 — 2 Cor 12:18; 2 Cor 7:5-6
- v14 — Eph 5:2; Rom 8:37; 2 Cor 2:15-16; Rom 6:17; 2 Cor 9:15
- v15 — Eph 5:2; 1 Cor 1:18; Ezek 20:41; Phil 4:18; Gen 8:21
- v16 — 2 Cor 3:5-6; John 9:39; 1 Pet 2:7-8; Luke 2:34; 1 Cor 15:10
- v17 — 2 Cor 4:2; 2 Cor 1:12; 2 Pet 2:1-3; 2 Tim 4:3-4; 1 Tim 4:1-3

Chapter 3

Paul declares that the Corinthians themselves are his letter of commendation, written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God on the tables of the heart. He contrasts the ministry of the old covenant — the letter that kills — with the ministry of the new covenant — the Spirit that gives life — and declares that where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.

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| 1 | <i>Do we begin again to commend ourselves? or need we, as some others, epistles of commendation to you, or letters of commendation from you?</i> | Are we beginning again to commend ourselves? Or do we need, as some others do, letters of recommendation to You or from You? |
| 2 | <i>Ye are our epistle written in our hearts, known and read of all men:</i> | You yourselves are our letter, written on our hearts, known and read by all men, |
| 3 | <i>Forasmuch as ye are manifestly declared to be the epistle of Christ ministered by us, written not with ink, but with the Spirit of the living God; not in tables of stone, but in fleshy tables of the heart.</i> | because You show that You are a letter from Christ delivered by us — written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God, not on tablets of stone but on tablets of human hearts. |
| 4 | <i>And such trust have we through Christ to God-ward:</i> | Such is the confidence we have through Christ toward God. |

- 5 *Not that we are sufficient of ourselves to think any thing as of ourselves; but our sufficiency is of God;* Not that we are sufficient in ourselves to claim anything as coming from ourselves — our sufficiency is from God,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. A covenant is stronger than a contract — it is a vow that changes who you are to each other. Here Paul contrasts the old covenant (the law of Moses) with the new covenant (life in the Spirit through Christ).

- 6 *Who also hath made us able ministers of the new testament; not of the letter, but of the spirit: for the letter killeth, but the spirit giveth life.* who has also made us able ministers of the new testament — not of the letter but of the Spirit. For the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life.
- 7 *But if the ministration of death, written and engraven in stones, was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not stedfastly behold the face of Moses for the glory of his countenance; which glory was to be done away:* Now if the ministry that brought death, engraved in letters on stones, came with such glory that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the face of Moses because of the glory of his countenance — a glory that was passing away —
- 8 *How shall not the ministration of the spirit be rather more glorious?* how much more glorious will the ministry of the Spirit be?
- 9 *For if the ministration of condemnation be glory, much more doth the ministration of righteousness exceed in glory.* For if the ministry that brought condemnation was glorious, how much more does the ministry that brings righteousness overflow with glory.
- 10 *For even that which was made glorious had no glory in this respect, by reason of the glory that excelleth.* Indeed, what once was glorious has no glory now in comparison with the surpassing glory.
- 11 *For if that which is done away was glorious, much more that which remaineth is glorious.* For if what was passing away came with glory, much more does what remains come with glory.
- 12 *Seeing then that we have such hope, we use great plainness of speech:* Since we have such a hope, we are very bold in our speech.

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| <p>13 <i>And not as Moses, which put a vail over his face, that the children of Israel could not stedfastly look to the end of that which is abolished:</i></p> <p>14 <i>But their minds were blinded: for until this day remaineth the same vail untaken away in the reading of the old testament; which vail is done away in Christ.</i></p> <p>15 <i>But even unto this day, when Moses is read, the vail is upon their heart.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Nevertheless when it shall turn to the Lord, the vail shall be taken away.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Now the Lord is that Spirit: and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But we all, with open face beholding as in a glass the glory of the Lord, are changed into the same image from glory to glory, even as by the Spirit of the Lord.</i></p> | <p>We are not like Moses, who put a veil over his face so that the children of Israel could not gaze on the end of what was passing away.</p> <p>But their minds were blinded, for to this day the same veil remains unlifted at the reading of the old testament — and only in Christ is it taken away.</p> <p>Even to this day, whenever Moses is read, a veil lies upon their hearts.</p> <p>But whenever the heart turns to the Lord, the veil is taken away.</p> <p>Now the Lord is that Spirit, and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.</p> <p>But we all, with open face beholding as in a glass the glory of the Lord, are changed into the same image from glory to glory, even as by the Spirit of the Lord.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 10:12; 2 Cor 12:11; 2 Cor 5:12; Acts 18:27; 1 Cor 16:3
- v2 — 1 Cor 9:1-2; Rom 1:8; 1 Thess 1:8; Phil 1:7
- v3 — Ezek 11:19; Jer 31:33; Heb 8:10; Heb 10:16; Ps 40:8
- v5 — 2 Cor 12:9; Phil 4:13; 1 Cor 15:10; Phil 2:13; John 15:5
- v6 — John 6:63; Rom 7:6; Rom 8:2; Jer 31:31; Heb 8:6-10
- v7 — 2 Cor 3:9-11; 1 Cor 13:10; Ex 31:18; Rom 10:4; Ex 24:12
- v11 — Rom 5:20-21; Heb 8:13; Heb 7:21-25
- v13 — Ex 34:33-35; Eph 2:14-15
- v14 — 2 Cor 4:3-4; Acts 26:18; Rom 11:25; Rom 11:7-10; John 12:40
- v16 — Ex 34:34; Isa 25:7; Isa 29:18; John 6:45-46; Jer 31:34
- v17 — Rom 8:2; John 8:32; Gal 5:13; Gal 4:6; Gal 5:1
- v18 — 2 Cor 4:6; Eph 4:22-24; Rom 12:2; 2 Cor 4:4; 1 Cor 13:12

Chapter 4

Paul declares that the god of this world has blinded the minds of unbelievers, but God has shined the light of the knowledge of His glory in the face of Jesus Christ. He describes the treasure of the gospel carried in earthen vessels, and though outwardly perishing, the inward man is renewed day by day — for the afflictions are light and momentary compared to the eternal weight of glory.

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| 1 | <i>Therefore seeing we have this ministry, as we have received mercy, we faint not;</i> | Therefore, since we have this ministry by the mercy we have received, we do not lose heart. |
| 2 | <i>But have renounced the hidden things of dishonesty, not walking in craftiness, nor handling the word of God deceitfully; but by manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God.</i> | We have renounced the hidden things of shame, refusing to walk in craftiness or to handle the word of God deceitfully. Instead, by the open declaration of the truth, we commend ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God. |
| 3 | <i>But if our gospel be hid, it is hid to them that are lost:</i> | But if our gospel is veiled, it is veiled to those who are perishing — |
| 4 | <i>In whom the god of this world hath blinded the minds of them which believe not, lest the light of the glorious gospel of Christ, who is the image of God, should shine unto them.</i> | the god of this world has blinded the minds of those who do not believe, so that the light of the glorious gospel of Christ, Who is the image of God, should not shine on them. |
| 5 | <i>For we preach not ourselves, but Christ Jesus the Lord; and ourselves your servants for Jesus' sake.</i> | For we do not preach ourselves, but Christ Jesus as Lord — and ourselves as Your servants for Jesus' sake. |
| 6 | <i>For God, who commanded the light to shine out of darkness, hath shined in our hearts, to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ.</i> | For God, Who commanded the light to shine out of darkness, hath shined in our hearts, to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ. |
| 7 | <i>But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of us.</i> | But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, so that the excellency of the power may be of God and not of us. |

- 8 *We are troubled on every side, yet not distressed; we are perplexed, but not in despair;* We are pressed on every side, yet not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair;
- 9 *Persecuted, but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed;* persecuted, but not forsaken; struck down, but not destroyed.
- 10 *Always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our body.* We are always carrying around in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, so that the life of Jesus also may be made known in our body.
- 11 *For we which live are alway delivered unto death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our mortal flesh.* For we who are alive are always being given over to death for Jesus' sake, so that the life of Jesus also may be made known in our mortal flesh.
- 12 *So then death worketh in us, but life in you.* So then death is at work in us, but life in You.
- 13 *We having the same spirit of faith, according as it is written, I believed, and therefore have I spoken; we also believe, and therefore speak;* We have the same spirit of faith as is written: "I believed, and therefore have I spoken." We also believe, and therefore speak,
- 14 *Knowing that he which raised up the Lord Jesus shall raise up us also by Jesus, and shall present us with you.* knowing that He who raised up the Lord Jesus will also raise us up with Jesus, and will present us together with You in His presence.
- 15 *For all things are for your sakes, that the abundant grace might through the thanksgiving of many redound to the glory of God.* For all these things are for Your sakes, so that grace, having reached more and more people, may cause thanksgiving to overflow to the glory of God.
- 16 *For which cause we faint not; but though our outward man perish, yet the inward man is renewed day by day.* Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outward man is perishing, yet the inward man is being renewed day by day.

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For our light affliction, which is but for a moment, worketh for us a far more exceeding and eternal weight of glory;

For our light affliction, which is but for a moment, worketh for us a far more exceeding and eternal weight of glory,
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While we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen: for the things which are seen are temporal; but the things which are not seen are eternal.

while we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen — for the things which are seen are temporal, but the things which are not seen are eternal.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Cor 2:17; 1 Thess 2:3-5; 2 Cor 5:11; 2 Cor 11:13-15; 1 Cor 4:5
- v3 — 2 Cor 3:14; 1 Cor 1:18; 2 Thess 2:9-11; 2 Cor 2:15-16; Matt 11:25
- v4 — John 12:40; Acts 26:18; 2 Cor 3:14; Isa 6:10; 1 John 5:19
- v6 — Isa 60:2; Gen 1:3; 1 Pet 2:9; 2 Pet 1:19; Eph 5:8
- v7 — 2 Cor 3:5-6; 2 Cor 5:1; Eph 2:8-9; 1 Cor 1:28; Col 2:3
- v8 — Jas 1:2-4; Rom 8:35-37; 1 Pet 4:12-14; 2 Cor 12:10; Ps 56:2-3
- v10 — Rom 6:5; 2 Tim 2:11; 1 Pet 4:13; Rom 6:8; Phil 3:10-11
- v11 — 1 Cor 15:49; Ps 44:22; 1 Cor 15:53-54; Rom 8:36; 1 Cor 15:31
- v13 — Ps 116:10; Heb 11:1-40; 2 Cor 3:12; 1 Cor 12:9; Rom 1:12
- v16 — Isa 40:31; Col 3:10; Isa 40:29; Rom 12:2; Ps 73:26
- v17 — Rom 8:18; 1 Pet 5:10; Rom 5:3-5; Jas 1:12; Heb 12:10-11
- v18 — 2 Cor 5:7; Rom 8:24-25; Heb 11:1; 1 John 2:16-17; 1 John 2:25

Chapter 5

Paul teaches that when our earthly body is dissolved, we have a building of God eternal in the heavens, and that to be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord. He declares that if any man is in Christ he is a new creature, and that God has given us the ministry of reconciliation — for He made Christ, who knew no sin, to be sin for us, that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him.

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For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

For we know that if the earthly tent we live in is taken down, we have a building from God — a house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

- 2 *For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven:* For in this present body we groan, longing to be clothed with our heavenly dwelling,
- 3 *If so be that being clothed we shall not be found naked.* if indeed, having been clothed, we shall not be found naked.
- 4 *For we that are in this tabernacle do groan, being burdened: not for that we would be unclothed, but clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up of life.* For we who are in this tent groan, being burdened — not that we wish to be unclothed, but to be further clothed, so that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life.
- 5 *Now he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.* Now He who has prepared us for this very thing is God, Who also has given us the Spirit as an earnest of what is to come.
- 6 *Therefore we are always confident, knowing that, whilst we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord:* Therefore we are always confident, knowing that while we are at home in the body, we are away from the Lord —
- 7 *(For we walk by faith, not by sight:)* for we walk by faith, not by sight.
- 8 *We are confident, I say, and willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be present with the Lord.* We are confident, I say, and we would prefer rather to be absent from the body and to be at home with the Lord.
- 9 *Wherefore we labour, that, whether present or absent, we may be accepted of him.* So we make it our aim, whether present or absent, to be pleasing to Him.
- 10 *For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ; that every one may receive the things done in his body, according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad.* For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ, so that each one may receive what is due for the things done in the body, according to what He has done, whether good or bad.

- 11 *Knowing therefore the terror of the Lord, we persuade men; but we are made manifest unto God; and I trust also are made manifest in your consciences.* Therefore, knowing the terror of the Lord, we persuade men. What we are is plain to God, and I hope it is plain also to Your consciences.
- 12 *For we commend not ourselves again unto you, but give you occasion to glory on our behalf, that ye may have somewhat to answer them which glory in appearance, and not in heart.* We are not commending ourselves to You again, but giving You reason to be proud of us — so You will have an answer for those who boast in outward appearance and not in the heart.
- 13 *For whether we be beside ourselves, it is to God: or whether we be sober, it is for your cause.* If we are out of our minds, it is for God; and if we are in our right mind, it is for You.
- 14 *For the love of Christ constraineth us; because we thus judge, that if one died for all, then were all dead:* For the love of Christ constrains us, because we have come to this conclusion: that one died for all, and therefore all died.
- 15 *And that he died for all, that they which live should not henceforth live unto themselves, but unto him which died for them, and rose again.* And He died for all so that those who live should no longer live for themselves, but for Him who died for them and rose again.
- 16 *Wherefore henceforth know we no man after the flesh: yea, though we have known Christ after the flesh, yet now henceforth know we him no more.* From now on, then, we regard no man after the flesh. Even if we have known Christ after the flesh, yet now we know Him so no longer.
- 17 *Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.* Therefore if any man be in Christ, He is a new creature: old things are passed away; look, all things are become new.
- 18 *And all things are of God, who hath reconciled us to himself by Jesus Christ, and hath given to us the ministry of reconciliation;* And all things are of God, Who has reconciled us to Himself through Jesus Christ and has given us the ministry of reconciliation:

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| <p>19 <i>To wit, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto himself, not imputing their trespasses unto them; and hath committed unto us the word of reconciliation.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Now then we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God did beseech you by us: we pray you in Christ's stead, be ye reconciled to God.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For he hath made him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him.</i></p> | <p>namely, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world to Himself, not imputing their trespasses to them; and He has committed to us the word of reconciliation.</p> <p>Now then, we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God were appealing through us; we plead with You in Christ's stead — be reconciled to God.</p> <p>For He hath made Him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Job 19:25-26; 1 John 3:2; 2 Pet 1:13-14; 2 Cor 4:7; Heb 9:24
- v5 — 2 Cor 1:22; Eph 1:13-14; Rom 8:23; Eph 4:30; 1 John 3:24
- v7 — Heb 11:1-27; 2 Cor 4:18; Rom 8:24-25; 1 Pet 1:8; Heb 10:38
- v8 — Phil 1:20-24; 2 Cor 5:6; John 14:3; 1 John 3:2; 2 Cor 12:2-3
- v10 — Matt 16:27; Rev 22:12; Eccl 12:14; Eph 6:8; Ps 62:12
- v14 — Gal 2:20; Rom 14:7-9; Matt 10:37-38; 1 Pet 1:8; Matt 20:28
- v15 — Rom 14:7-9; 1 Pet 4:2-4; 1 Pet 1:14-15; Col 3:1; Col 3:17
- v17 — Ezek 36:26; Eph 4:22-24; Isa 43:18-19; John 3:3; Ps 51:10
- v18 — Col 1:20-21; Rom 5:10-11; 2 Cor 5:19-20; Eph 2:16-17; 1 John 4:10
- v19 — Isa 43:25; Isa 44:22; 1 John 4:10; 1 John 2:1-2; 1 Tim 3:16
- v20 — Eph 6:20; Luke 14:23; Mal 2:7; Ezek 18:31-32; Isa 55:6-7
- v21 — 1 Pet 2:22-24; 1 Pet 3:18; Rom 5:19; Gal 3:13; 1 Cor 1:30

Chapter 6

Paul urges the Corinthians not to receive the grace of God in vain and describes the hardships of his ministry — in afflictions, labors, watchings, and fastings. He commands them to be not unequally yoked together with unbelievers, for what fellowship has righteousness with unrighteousness, or what communion has light with darkness.

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| <p>1 <i>We then, as workers together with him, beseech you also that ye receive not the grace of God in vain.</i></p> | <p>As workers together with Him, we plead with you also not to receive the grace of God in vain.</p> |
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| 2 <i>(For he saith, I have heard thee in a time accepted, and in the day of salvation have I succoured thee: behold, now is the accepted time; behold, now is the day of salvation.)</i> | For He says, "In the acceptable time I have heard you, and in the day of salvation I have helped you." Now is the acceptable time; now is the day of salvation. |
| 3 <i>Giving no offence in any thing, that the ministry be not blamed:</i> | We give no offense in anything, so that our ministry may not be blamed; |
| 4 <i>But in all things approving ourselves as the ministers of God, in much patience, in afflictions, in necessities, in distresses,</i> | but in everything we commend ourselves as ministers of God: in much patience, in afflictions, in hardships, in distresses, |
| 5 <i>In stripes, in imprisonments, in tumults, in labours, in watchings, in fastings;</i> | in beatings, in imprisonments, in riots, in labors, in sleepless nights, in fastings; |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — *patient endurance with people who are difficult or slow; God's slowness to anger. It is not weakness — it is the power to keep loving when you have every reason to give up. God is longsuffering toward sinners, not wanting any to perish.*

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the old English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is fully God — He comforts, teaches, convicts of sin, and gives new life to those who believe.*

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| 6 <i>By pureness, by knowledge, by longsuffering, by kindness, by the Holy Ghost, by love unfeigned,</i> | by purity, by knowledge, by longsuffering, by kindness, by the Holy Ghost, by sincere love, |
| 7 <i>By the word of truth, by the power of God, by the armour of righteousness on the right hand and on the left,</i> | by the word of truth, by the power of God, with the armor of righteousness for the right hand and the left, |
| 8 <i>By honour and dishonour, by evil report and good report: as deceivers, and yet true;</i> | through honor and dishonor, through bad report and good report — regarded as deceivers, and yet true; |
| 9 <i>As unknown, and yet well known; as dying, and, behold, we live; as chastened, and not killed;</i> | as unknown, and yet well known; as dying, and yet we live; as chastened, and yet not killed; |

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| <p>10 <i>As sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; as poor, yet making many rich; as having nothing, and yet possessing all things.</i></p> <p>11 <i>O ye Corinthians, our mouth is open unto you, our heart is enlarged.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Ye are not straitened in us, but ye are straitened in your own bowels.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Now for a recompence in the same, (I speak as unto my children,) be ye also enlarged.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness?</i></p> <p>15 <i>And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel?</i></p> | <p>as sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; as poor, yet making many rich; as having nothing, and yet possessing all things.</p> <p>O Corinthians, we have spoken openly to You, our heart is wide open.</p> <p>You are not held back by us; You are held back by Your own affections.</p> <p>Now in fair exchange — I speak as to my children — open wide Your hearts also.</p> <p>Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers — for what fellowship has righteousness with unrighteousness? And what communion has light with darkness?</p> <p>And what concord has Christ with Belial? Or what part has a believer with an unbeliever?</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Belial** (BEE-lee-al) — "worthlessness, wickedness" — A Hebrew word that became a name for Satan, the supreme worthless one. To call someone a "son of Belial" in the OT was to call them godless and depraved. Paul here uses Belial as a personal name for the devil — the absolute moral opposite of Christ.

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| <p>16 <i>And what agreement hath the temple of God with idols? for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing; and I will receive you,</i></p> | <p>And what agreement has the temple of God with idols? For You are the temple of the living God. As God has said: "I will dwell in them and walk among them; and I will be their God, and they shall be My people."</p> <p>Therefore "come out from among them and be separate, says the Lord. Do not touch the unclean thing, and I will receive You.</p> |
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- 18

And will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be my sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty.
- I will be a Father to You, and You shall be My sons and daughters, says the Lord Almighty."

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 12:15; 1 Cor 3:9; 1 Pet 4:10; Gal 2:21; 2 Cor 5:18-20
- v2 — Isa 49:8; Heb 4:7; Heb 3:13; Isa 61:2; Heb 3:7
- v3 — Rom 14:13; 1 Cor 9:12
- v4 — 2 Cor 12:10; 2 Cor 4:8; 2 Cor 11:27; 1 Cor 4:11-12; Rom 8:35-36
- v6 — Eph 4:32; Col 1:27; Eph 4:2; Gal 5:22; 2 Cor 3:3
- v7 — 2 Cor 4:2; Eph 6:11-20; 2 Tim 2:15; 2 Cor 10:4-5; Eph 3:20
- v10 — John 16:22; 2 Cor 8:9; Rev 2:9; Jas 2:5; 1 Tim 4:8
- v11 — 2 Cor 12:15; Ps 119:32; 2 Cor 7:3-4; Phil 1:8
- v14 — 1 Cor 15:33; 1 Cor 10:21; Jas 4:4; Eph 5:6-14; Lev 19:19
- v16 — Rev 21:3; Ex 29:45; Heb 8:10; Lev 26:12; Jer 32:38
- v17 — Isa 52:11; Rev 18:4; 2 Cor 7:1; Ps 1:1-3; Num 16:26
- v18 — Rev 21:7; John 1:12; 2 Sam 7:14; Gal 4:5-7; Rom 8:14-17

Chapter 7

Paul urges the Corinthians to cleanse themselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit and expresses his joy over Titus's report of their repentance. He distinguishes godly sorrow, which produces repentance leading to salvation, from the sorrow of the world, which produces death.

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Having therefore these promises, dearly beloved, let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.
- Therefore, dearly beloved, since we have these promises, let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.
- 2

Receive us; we have wronged no man, we have corrupted no man, we have defrauded no man.
- Open your hearts to us. We have wronged no one, we have corrupted no one, we have defrauded no one.
- 3

I speak not this to condemn you: for I have said before, that ye are in our hearts to die together and live together.
- I do not say this to condemn you, for I have said before that you are in our hearts, to die with us and to live with us.

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| 4 | <i>Great is my boldness of speech toward you, great is my glorying of you: I am filled with comfort, I am exceeding joyful in all our tribulation.</i> | Great is my boldness of speech toward you; great is my boasting on your behalf. I am filled with comfort; I am exceedingly joyful in all our tribulation. |
| 5 | <i>For, when we were come into Macedonia, our flesh had no rest, but we were troubled on every side; without were fightings, within were fears.</i> | For when we came into Macedonia, our flesh had no rest. We were troubled on every side: outside were conflicts, inside were fears. |
| 6 | <i>Nevertheless God, that comforteth those that are cast down, comforted us by the coming of Titus;</i> | But God, Who comforts those who are downcast, comforted us by the coming of Titus, |
| 7 | <i>And not by his coming only, but by the consolation wherewith he was comforted in you, when he told us your earnest desire, your mourning, your fervent mind toward me; so that I rejoiced the more.</i> | and not by his coming only, but also by the consolation with which he was comforted in you when he told us of your earnest desire, your mourning, your fervent zeal toward me — so that I rejoiced even more. |
| 8 | <i>For though I made you sorry with a letter, I do not repent, though I did repent: for I perceive that the same epistle hath made you sorry, though it were but for a season.</i> | For though I made you sorry with my letter, I do not regret it now — though I once did regret it. I see that the same letter made you sorry, though only for a season. |
| 9 | <i>Now I rejoice, not that ye were made sorry, but that ye sorrowed to repentance: for ye were made sorry after a godly manner, that ye might receive damage by us in nothing.</i> | Now I rejoice — not that you were made sorry, but that your sorrow led to repentance. You were made sorry in a godly way, so that you suffered no loss through us. |
| 10 | <i>For godly sorrow worketh repentance to salvation not to be repented of: but the sorrow of the world worketh death.</i> | For godly sorrow produces repentance leading to salvation, not to be regretted; but the sorrow of the world produces death. |

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| <p>11 <i>For behold this selfsame thing, that ye sorrowed after a godly sort, what carefulness it wrought in you, yea, what clearing of yourselves, yea, what indignation, yea, what fear, yea, what vehement desire, yea, what zeal, yea, what revenge! In all things ye have approved yourselves to be clear in this matter.</i></p> | <p>See what this very thing — your godly sorrow — produced in you: what earnestness, what eagerness to clear yourselves, what indignation, what fear, what longing, what zeal, what readiness to set things right! In every way you have shown yourselves to be clear in this matter.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>Wherefore, though I wrote unto you, I did it not for his cause that had done the wrong, nor for his cause that suffered wrong, but that our care for you in the sight of God might appear unto you.</i></p> | <p>So then, though I wrote to you, it was not for the sake of the one who did the wrong, nor for the sake of the one who suffered the wrong, but so that our earnest care for you might be made plain to you in the sight of God.</p> |
| <p>13 <i>Therefore we were comforted in your comfort: yea, and exceedingly the more joyed we for the joy of Titus, because his spirit was refreshed by you all.</i></p> | <p>Therefore we were comforted by your comfort. And we rejoiced exceedingly the more for the joy of Titus, because his spirit was refreshed by you all.</p> |
| <p>14 <i>For if I have boasted any thing to him of you, I am not ashamed; but as we spake all things to you in truth, even so our boasting, which I made before Titus, is found a truth.</i></p> | <p>For if I have boasted anything to him about you, I am not ashamed; but just as we spoke all things to you in truth, so also our boasting to Titus has proved true.</p> |
| <p>15 <i>And his inward affection is more abundant toward you, whilst he remembereth the obedience of you all, how with fear and trembling ye received him.</i></p> | <p>And his affection for you is even greater as he remembers the obedience of you all, how you received him with fear and trembling.</p> |
| <p>16 <i>I rejoyce therefore that I have confidence in you in all things.</i></p> | <p>I rejoyce that I have complete confidence in you.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Thess 4:7; 1 Pet 2:11; Jas 4:8; Prov 8:13; Ps 51:10
v2 — 2 Cor 6:12-13; 2 Cor 11:9; Acts 20:33
v3 — Phil 1:8-9; 2 Cor 6:11-12
v4 — 2 Cor 1:4; Jas 1:2; 2 Cor 3:12
v5 — 2 Cor 2:13; Deut 32:25
v6 — 2 Thess 2:16-17; 2 Cor 1:3-4; 3 John 1:2-4; 2 Cor 7:13; Jer 31:13
v9 — Luke 15:7; Jer 31:18-20
v10 — Acts 3:19; Acts 11:18; 2 Tim 2:25-26; 2 Sam 12:13; Luke 18:13
v11 — Rom 14:18; 1 Tim 5:21-22; 2 Tim 2:15; Ps 2:11; Eph 5:11
v12 — 2 Cor 2:9; 1 Tim 3:5
v13 — 2 Cor 7:6
v15 — Phil 2:12; 2 Cor 2:9; 1 John 3:17; Ps 119:120; Isa 66:2

Chapter 8

Paul holds up the generosity of the Macedonian churches as an example, urging the Corinthians to complete the collection they began the year before. He reminds them that the Lord Jesus Christ, though He was rich, became poor for their sakes, so that through His poverty they might be rich.

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| <p>1 <i>Moreover, brethren, we do you to wit of the grace of God bestowed on the churches of Macedonia;</i></p> | <p>Now, brothers, we want You to know about the grace of God which has been given to the churches of Macedonia:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>How that in a great trial of affliction the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their liberality.</i></p> | <p>how in the midst of a great trial of affliction, the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty overflowed into the riches of their generosity.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For to their power, I bear record, yea, and beyond their power they were willing of themselves;</i></p> | <p>For I testify that they gave according to their ability — yes, and beyond their ability — entirely on their own,</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Praying us with much intreaty that we would receive the gift, and take upon us the fellowship of the ministering to the saints.</i></p> | <p>begging us with much entreaty that we would receive their gift and let them share in the ministry to the saints.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And this they did, not as we hoped, but first gave their own selves to the Lord, and unto us by the will of God.</i></p> | <p>And they did this not as we had hoped — they first gave themselves to the Lord, and then to us, by the will of God.</p> |

- 6 *Insomuch that we desired Titus, that as he had begun, so he would also finish in you the same grace also.* So we urged Titus, that as he had begun, he would also complete this grace in you as well.
- 7 *Therefore, as ye abound in every thing, in faith, and utterance, and knowledge, and in all diligence, and in your love to us, see that ye abound in this grace also.* But as you abound in everything — in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in all diligence, and in your love for us — see that you abound in this grace also.
- 8 *I speak not by commandment, but by occasion of the forwardness of others, and to prove the sincerity of your love.* I am not speaking by commandment, but by occasion of the eagerness of others — and to test the sincerity of your love.
- 9 *For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.* For You know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ — that though He was rich, yet for Your sakes He became poor, that ye through His poverty might be rich.
- 10 *And herein I give my advice: for this is expedient for you, who have begun before, not only to do, but also to be forward a year ago.* And in this I give my advice: this is best for You, who began a year ago not only to give but also to be eager to give.
- 11 *Now therefore perform the doing of it; that as there was a readiness to will, so there may be a performance also out of that which ye have.* Now finish doing it, so that just as You were ready in willingness, You may also complete it out of what You have.
- 12 *For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not.* For if the willingness is there first, the gift is acceptable according to what a man has, not according to what he does not have.
- 13 *For I mean not that other men be eased, and ye burdened:* I do not mean that others should be eased and You burdened,

- 14 *But by an equality, that now at this time your abundance may be a supply for their want, that their abundance also may be a supply for your want: that there may be equality:* but that there should be equality — that now at this time Your abundance may supply their lack, so that their abundance may also supply Your lack, that there may be equality.
- 15 *As it is written, He that had gathered much had nothing over; and he that had gathered little had no lack.* As it is written: "He who gathered much had nothing over, and he who gathered little had no lack."
- 16 *But thanks be to God, which put the same earnest care into the heart of Titus for you.* But thanks be to God, Who put the same earnest care for you into the heart of Titus.
- 17 *For indeed he accepted the exhortation; but being more forward, of his own accord he went unto you.* For he not only accepted our appeal, but being himself even more eager, he is coming to you of his own accord.
- 18 *And we have sent with him the brother, whose praise is in the gospel throughout all the churches;* And we have sent along with him the brother whose praise in the gospel is known throughout all the churches.
- 19 *And not that only, but who was also chosen of the churches to travel with us with this grace, which is administered by us to the glory of the same Lord, and declaration of your ready mind:* And not only that, but he was also chosen by the churches to travel with us with this gift, which is administered by us to the glory of the Lord Himself and to show our ready mind,
- 20 *Avoiding this, that no man should blame us in this abundance which is administered by us:* guarding against this — that no man should blame us in our administration of this generous gift.
- 21 *Providing for honest things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men.* For we are providing what is honorable, not only in the sight of the Lord but also in the sight of men.

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| <p>22 <i>And we have sent with them our brother, whom we have oftentimes proved diligent in many things, but now much more diligent, upon the great confidence which he hath in you.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Whether any do enquire of Titus, he is my partner and fellowhelper concerning you: or our brethren be enquired of, they are the messengers of the churches, and the glory of Christ.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Wherefore shew ye to them, and before the churches, the proof of your love, and of our boasting on your behalf.</i></p> | <p>And we have sent with them our brother, whom we have often proved to be diligent in many things, and is now even more diligent because of the great confidence he has in you.</p> <p>If anyone inquires about Titus, he is my partner and fellow worker for you. As for our brothers, they are the messengers of the churches, the glory of Christ.</p> <p>Therefore show to them, and before the churches, the proof of Your love and of our boasting about You.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jas 2:5; Prov 11:25; 2 Cor 6:10; Deut 15:4; 2 Cor 9:13
- v3 — Ex 35:29; Ex 35:5; Ex 35:21-22; 2 Cor 9:6-7; Phlm 1:14
- v4 — Gal 6:10; Acts 24:17; 2 Cor 9:1; Heb 6:10
- v5 — Rom 12:1; Rom 6:13; Rom 14:7-9
- v6 — 2 Cor 12:18; 2 Cor 8:16-17; 2 Cor 8:19
- v7 — 2 Cor 9:8; 2 Pet 1:5-8; 2 Thess 1:3; Phil 1:9; 1 Cor 13:2
- v8 — 1 Cor 7:6; 1 John 3:17-19; 1 Pet 1:22; Jas 2:14-16; Heb 10:24
- v9 — Rom 8:32; Phil 2:6-8; Matt 20:28; Rom 5:8; 2 Cor 6:10
- v10 — 1 Tim 6:18-19; Heb 13:16; Jas 2:15-16; Prov 19:17; 2 Cor 9:2
- v12 — Mark 12:42-44; 2 Cor 9:7; Ex 35:29; Luke 21:1-4; Ex 35:21-22
- v15 — Ex 16:18; Luke 22:35
- v21 — Rom 12:17; 1 Pet 2:12; Phil 4:8; Titus 2:5-8; 2 Cor 2:17

Chapter 9

Paul encourages the Corinthians to give generously to the collection, teaching that he who sows bountifully shall also reap bountifully. He declares that God loves a cheerful giver and is able to make all grace abound toward them, so that they always have sufficiency in all things.

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| <p>1 <i>For as touching the ministering to the saints, it is superfluous for me to write to you:</i></p> | <p>As concerning the ministry to the saints, it is unnecessary for me to write to you,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For I know the forwardness of your mind, for which I boast of you to them of Macedonia, that Achaia was ready a year ago; and your zeal hath provoked very many.</i></p> | <p>for I know your eagerness, of which I boast to the Macedonians, saying that Achaia was ready a year ago — and your zeal has stirred up the majority of them.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Yet have I sent the brethren, lest our boasting of you should be in vain in this behalf; that, as I said, ye may be ready:</i></p> | <p>Yet I have sent the brothers so that our boasting about you would not be in vain in this matter, but that you may be ready, as I said you would be.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Lest haply if they of Macedonia come with me, and find you unprepared, we (that we say not, ye) should be ashamed in this same confident boasting.</i></p> | <p>Otherwise, if any Macedonians come with me and find you unprepared, we — not to say you — would be ashamed of this same confident boasting.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Therefore I thought it necessary to exhort the brethren, that they would go before unto you, and make up beforehand your bounty, whereof ye had notice before, that the same might be ready, as a matter of bounty, and not as of covetousness.</i></p> | <p>So I thought it necessary to urge the brothers to go ahead to you and arrange beforehand the bounty you had promised, so that it would be ready as a generous gift and not as a grudging one.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>But this I say, He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully.</i></p> | <p>But this I say: he which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.</i></p> | <p>Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>And God is able to make all grace abound toward you; that ye, always having all sufficiency in all things, may abound to every good work:</i></p> <p>9 <i>(As it is written, He hath dispersed abroad; he hath given to the poor: his righteousness remaineth for ever.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Now he that ministereth seed to the sower both minister bread for your food, and multiply your seed sown, and increase the fruits of your righteousness;)</i></p> <p>11 <i>Being enriched in every thing to all bountifulness, which causeth through us thanksgiving to God.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For the administration of this service not only supplieth the want of the saints, but is abundant also by many thanksgivings unto God;</i></p> <p>13 <i>Whiles by the experiment of this ministration they glorify God for your professed subjection unto the gospel of Christ, and for your liberal distribution unto them, and unto all men;</i></p> <p>14 <i>And by their prayer for you, which long after you for the exceeding grace of God in you.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Thanks be unto God for his unspeakable gift.</i></p> | <p>And God is able to make all grace abound toward you, so that always, having all sufficiency in all things, you may abound in every good work.</p> <p>As it is written: "He has dispersed abroad, He has given to the poor; His righteousness endures forever."</p> <p>Now He who supplies seed to the sower and bread for food will supply and multiply your seed sown, and will increase the fruits of your righteousness.</p> <p>You will be enriched in everything for all generosity, which through us produces thanksgiving to God.</p> <p>For the administration of this service not only supplies the needs of the saints, but is also overflowing in many thanksgivings to God.</p> <p>While by the proof of this ministry they glorify God for Your confessed obedience to the gospel of Christ, and for Your generous giving to them and to all men,</p> <p>and by their prayer for You, in which they long after You for the exceeding grace of God in You.</p> <p>Thanks be to God for His unspeakable gift!</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v2 — 2 Cor 8:10

v6 — Prov 11:24-25; Luke 6:38; Prov 22:9; Prov 19:17; 2 Cor 9:10

v7 — 2 Cor 8:12; Acts 20:35; 1 Chr 29:17; Ex 25:2; Prov 11:25

v8 — Eph 3:20; Phil 4:18-19; Prov 10:22; Mal 3:10; Hag 2:8

v9 — Ps 112:9; Ps 112:3; Prov 21:21

v10 — Isa 55:10; Hos 10:12; 2 Cor 9:6; Eccl 11:6; 1 Thess 3:12

v11 — 2 Cor 4:15; 1 Tim 6:17-18; 1 Chr 29:12-14; 2 Cor 9:12; 2 Cor 1:11

v12 — 2 Cor 8:14-15; Phlm 1:4-7; Phil 2:25

v15 — 2 Cor 2:14; John 3:16; Eph 5:20; Rom 8:32; Jas 1:17

Chapter 10

Paul defends his authority, declaring that though he walks in the flesh, he does not war after the flesh — the weapons of his warfare are mighty through God to the pulling down of strongholds. He warns those who accuse him of being bold only in letters that when he comes in person, his actions will match his words.

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| <p>¹ <i>Now I Paul myself beseech you by the meekness and gentleness of Christ, who in presence am base among you, but being absent am bold toward you:</i></p> | <p>Now I, Paul, myself appeal to you by the meekness and gentleness of Christ — I who am timid when face to face with You, but bold when away from You.</p> |
| <p>² <i>But I beseech you, that I may not be bold when I am present with that confidence, wherewith I think to be bold against some, which think of us as if we walked according to the flesh.</i></p> | <p>I beg You that when I am present I may not have to be as bold as I now intend to be against some who think we are walking according to the flesh.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh:</i></p> | <p>For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh.</p> |
| <p>⁴ <i>(For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;)</i></p> | <p>For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strongholds.</p> |
| <p>⁵ <i>Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ;</i></p> | <p>We cast down imaginations and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, and we bring every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ;</p> |
| <p>⁶ <i>And having in a readiness to revenge all disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled.</i></p> | <p>and we are ready to punish every disobedience, once Your obedience is complete.</p> |

- 7 *Do ye look on things after the outward appearance? If any man trust to himself that he is Christ's, let him of himself think this again, that, as he is Christ's, even so are we Christ's.* Do You look on things after the outward appearance? If anyone is confident that he is Christ's, let Him consider this again — that just as He is Christ's, so also are we.
- 8 *For though I should boast somewhat more of our authority, which the Lord hath given us for edification, and not for your destruction, I should not be ashamed:* For even if I should boast somewhat more about our authority — which the Lord has given us for building You up and not for tearing You down — I would not be ashamed.
- 9 *That I may not seem as if I would terrify you by letters.* I do not want it to seem that I am trying to terrify You with my letters.
- 10 *For his letters, say they, are weighty and powerful; but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech contemptible.* "For His letters," they say, "are weighty and powerful, but His bodily presence is weak, and His speech contemptible."
- 11 *Let such an one think this, that, such as we are in word by letters when we are absent, such will we be also in deed when we are present.* Let such a person consider this: what we are in word by letters when absent, such we will also be in deed when present.
- 12 *For we dare not make ourselves of the number, or compare ourselves with some that commend themselves; but they measuring themselves by themselves, and comparing themselves among themselves, are not wise.* For we dare not class or compare ourselves with some who commend themselves; but they, measuring themselves by themselves and comparing themselves among themselves, are not wise.
- 13 *But we will not boast of things without our measure, but according to the measure of the rule which God hath distributed to us, a measure to reach even unto you.* But we will not boast of things beyond our measure, but only according to the measure of the sphere which God has assigned to us — a measure that reaches even to You.

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| <p>14 <i>For we stretch not ourselves beyond our measure, as though we reached not unto you: for we are come as far as to you also in preaching the gospel of Christ:</i></p> <p>15 <i>Not boasting of things without our measure, that is, of other men's labours; but having hope, when your faith is increased, that we shall be enlarged by you according to our rule abundantly,</i></p> <p>16 <i>To preach the gospel in the regions beyond you, and not to boast in another man's line of things made ready to our hand.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But he that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord.</i></p> <p>18 <i>For not he that commendeth himself is approved, but whom the Lord commendeth.</i></p> | <p>For we are not stretching ourselves beyond our measure, as though we did not reach to You — for we did come as far as You with the gospel of Christ.</p> <p>We do not boast beyond our measure in the labors of other men, but we have hope that as Your faith grows, our sphere of work will be greatly enlarged among You, according to our rule,</p> <p>so that we may preach the gospel in the regions beyond You, and not boast in another man's territory in things already prepared.</p> <p>But He who glories, let him glory in the Lord.</p> <p>For it is not the one who commends himself who is approved, but the one whom the Lord commends.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 10:10; Matt 11:29; Gal 5:2; Rom 12:1; Isa 42:3-4
- v2 — 2 Cor 13:10; 2 Cor 13:2; Gal 5:16-25
- v3 — 2 Cor 10:4; 1 Pet 4:1-2; Gal 2:20; Rom 8:13; 2 Tim 2:3-4
- v4 — 2 Cor 6:7; Eph 6:13-18; Jer 1:10; 1 Cor 2:5; 1 Sam 17:45-50
- v5 — Heb 4:12; Isa 55:7; 1 Pet 1:14-15; Rom 7:23; Matt 15:19
- v6 — 2 Cor 2:9; Num 16:26-30; 2 Cor 7:15; 2 Cor 13:2; 1 Cor 5:3-5
- v7 — 1 Cor 14:37; John 7:24; 2 Cor 5:12; 2 Cor 11:23
- v12 — Prov 27:2; Prov 26:12; 2 Cor 10:18; Luke 18:11; Rom 15:18
- v13 — Rom 12:6; 2 Cor 10:14-15; Rom 15:20; 1 Pet 4:10
- v15 — Rom 15:20; 2 Thess 1:3; 2 Cor 10:13
- v17 — Jer 9:23-24; 1 Cor 1:31; Jas 1:9-10; Isa 65:16
- v18 — Prov 21:2; Luke 16:15; 1 Cor 4:5; Rom 2:29; 2 Cor 10:12

Chapter 11

Paul warns that false apostles disguise themselves as ministers of righteousness, just as Satan transforms himself into an angel of light. He reluctantly boasts of his sufferings — beaten, stoned, shipwrecked, in perils on every side — to show that his credentials surpass those of the false teachers troubling Corinth.

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| 1 <i>Would to God ye could bear with me a little in my folly: and indeed bear with me.</i> | I wish you would bear with me a little in my folly — and indeed you do bear with me. |
| 2 <i>For I am jealous over you with godly jealousy: for I have espoused you to one husband, that I may present you as a chaste virgin to Christ.</i> | For I am jealous over You with a godly jealousy. I have promised You to one husband, to present You as a chaste virgin to Christ. |
| 3 <i>But I fear, lest by any means, as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty, so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ.</i> | But I fear that, just as the serpent beguiled Eve by his subtilty, so your minds may be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ. |
| 4 <i>For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if ye receive another spirit, which ye have not received, or another gospel, which ye have not accepted, ye might well bear with him.</i> | For if someone comes preaching another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if You receive another spirit, which You have not received, or another gospel, which You have not accepted — you bear with Him easily enough. |
| 5 <i>For I suppose I was not a whit behind the very chiefest apostles.</i> | For I consider that I am in no way behind the very chiefest apostles. |
| 6 <i>But though I be rude in speech, yet not in knowledge; but we have been thoroughly made manifest among you in all things.</i> | Even though I am untrained in speech, I am not so in knowledge — but in every way we have been thoroughly made known to You in all things. |
| 7 <i>Have I committed an offence in abasing myself that ye might be exalted, because I have preached to you the gospel of God freely?</i> | Did I commit an offence by humbling myself so that You might be exalted, because I preached the gospel of God to You free of charge? |

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| 8 | <i>I robbed other churches, taking wages of them, to do you service.</i> | I robbed other churches, taking wages from them, to serve You. |
| 9 | <i>And when I was present with you, and wanted, I was chargeable to no man: for that which was lacking to me the brethren which came from Macedonia supplied: and in all things I have kept myself from being burdensome unto you, and so will I keep myself.</i> | And when I was with You and in need, I was a burden to no one. For what I lacked, the brothers who came from Macedonia supplied. And in everything I have kept myself from being burdensome to You, and so will I continue to keep myself. |
| 10 | <i>As the truth of Christ is in me, no man shall stop me of this boasting in the regions of Achaia.</i> | As the truth of Christ is in me, no one shall stop me of this boasting in the regions of Achaia. |
| 11 | <i>Wherefore? because I love you not? God knoweth.</i> | Why? Because I do not love You? God knows I do. |
| 12 | <i>But what I do, that I will do, that I may cut off occasion from them which desire occasion; that wherein they glory, they may be found even as we.</i> | But what I am doing, I will continue to do, in order to cut off the opportunity from those who want one — so that in their boasting they may be found just as we are. |
| 13 | <i>For such are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into the apostles of Christ.</i> | For such are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into apostles of Christ. |
| 14 | <i>And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light.</i> | And no wonder — for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light. |
| 15 | <i>Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also be transformed as the ministers of righteousness; whose end shall be according to their works.</i> | It is no great thing, then, if his ministers also are transformed as ministers of righteousness — whose end shall be according to their works. |
| 16 | <i>I say again, Let no man think me a fool; if otherwise, yet as a fool receive me, that I may boast myself a little.</i> | I say again, let no man think me a fool. But if you do, then receive me as a fool, so that I also may boast a little. |

- 17 *That which I speak, I speak it not after the Lord, but as it were foolishly, in this confidence of boasting.* What I am saying, I do not say according to the Lord, but as it were foolishly, in this confidence of boasting.
- 18 *Seeing that many glory after the flesh, I will glory also.* Since many boast after the flesh, I will boast also.
- 19 *For ye suffer fools gladly, seeing ye yourselves are wise.* For you suffer fools gladly, since you yourselves are so wise.
- 20 *For ye suffer, if a man bring you into bondage, if a man devour you, if a man take of you, if a man exalt himself, if a man smite you on the face.* For you put up with it if a man brings you into bondage, if a man devours you, if a man takes from you, if a man exalts himself, if a man strikes you on the face.
- 21 *I speak as concerning reproach, as though we had been weak. Howbeit whereinsoever any is bold, (I speak foolishly,) I am bold also.* To my shame, I say that we were too weak for that! But in whatever anyone is bold — I speak foolishly — I am bold also.
- 22 *Are they Hebrews? so am I. Are they Israelites? so am I. Are they the seed of Abraham? so am I.* Are they Hebrews? So am I. Are they Israelites? So am I. Are they the seed of Abraham? So am I.
- 23 *Are they ministers of Christ? (I speak as a fool) I am more; in labours more abundant, in stripes above measure, in prisons more frequent, in deaths oft.* Are they ministers of Christ? (I speak as a fool.) I am more so — in labors more abundant, in stripes above measure, in prisons more often, in deaths frequently.
- 24 *Of the Jews five times received I forty stripes save one.* From the Jews five times I received forty stripes save one.
- 25 *Thrice was I beaten with rods, once was I stoned, thrice I suffered shipwreck, a night and a day I have been in the deep;* Three times I was beaten with rods, once I was stoned, three times I was shipwrecked, a night and a day I have been adrift on the deep.

- 26 *In journeyings often, in perils of waters, in perils of robbers, in perils by mine own countrymen, in perils by the heathen, in perils in the city, in perils in the wilderness, in perils in the sea, in perils among false brethren;* I have been in journeyings often, in perils of waters, in perils of robbers, in perils from my own countrymen, in perils from the heathen, in perils in the city, in perils in the wilderness, in perils in the sea, in perils among false brothers;
- 27 *In weariness and painfulness, in watchings often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings often, in cold and nakedness.* in weariness and painfulness, in watchings often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings often, in cold and nakedness.
- 28 *Beside those things that are without, that which cometh upon me daily, the care of all the churches.* Besides all those outward things, there is what comes on me daily: the care of all the churches.
- 29 *Who is weak, and I am not weak? who is offended, and I burn not?* Who is weak, and I am not weak? Who is offended, and I do not burn with grief?
- 30 *If I must needs glory, I will glory of the things which concern mine infirmities.* If I must boast, I will boast of the things which concern my weaknesses.
- 31 *The God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is blessed for evermore, knoweth that I lie not.* The God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, Who is blessed forevermore, knows that I do not lie.
- 32 *In Damascus the governor under Aretas the king kept the city of the Damascenes with a garrison, desirous to apprehend me:* In Damascus the governor under King Aretas guarded the city of the Damascenes with a garrison, wanting to arrest me;

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Damascus** (duh-MAS-kus) — *The ancient capital of Syria, northeast of Galilee; one of the oldest continuously inhabited cities in the world. It was on the road to Damascus that Saul of Tarsus was confronted by the risen Christ and converted (Acts 9). Paul's escape from the city in a basket, told here, is also recorded in Acts 9:23–25.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Aretas** (AIR-uh-tas) — Aretas IV, king of the Nabataean Arabs, whose territory bordered Damascus. He ruled from roughly 9 BC to AD 40. His daughter had been married to Herod Antipas before Herod divorced her for Herodias, sparking enmity between Aretas and the Herods. At this time Aretas held political control of Damascus, and his governor was hunting for Paul.

33 <i>And through a window in a basket was I let down by the wall, and escaped his hands.</i>	and I was let down through a window in a basket by the wall, and so escaped His hands.
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 11:4; 1 Cor 1:21
- v2 — Hos 2:19-20; Eph 5:26-27; Isa 54:5; Col 1:28; John 3:29
- v3 — Col 2:8; Gal 1:6; Eph 4:14; 1 John 4:1; Col 2:4
- v4 — Gal 1:6-8; 1 Cor 3:11; Eph 4:4-5; 1 Tim 2:5
- v6 — 1 Cor 1:17; Eph 3:4; 2 Cor 4:2; 1 Cor 1:21
- v13 — Rev 2:2; Gal 1:7; 1 John 4:1; Phil 3:2; Gal 2:4
- v14 — Gal 1:8; 2 Cor 2:11; 2 Cor 11:3; Rev 12:9; Matt 4:1-10
- v22 — Phil 3:5; Rom 11:1
- v23 — 2 Cor 6:4-5; Col 1:24; 2 Cor 6:9; 2 Cor 1:9-10; 1 Cor 15:10
- v27 — 2 Cor 6:5; Phil 4:12; 1 Thess 2:9; 2 Thess 3:8; 1 Cor 4:11-12
- v28 — 1 Cor 7:17; Rom 15:16
- v30 — 2 Cor 12:5-11; Jer 9:23-24; Prov 25:27; 1 Cor 2:3

Chapter 12

Paul tells of a man caught up to the third heaven who heard unspeakable words, and reveals that he was given a thorn in the flesh to keep him humble. The Lord told him, "My grace is sufficient for thee: for My strength is made perfect in weakness," and Paul declares that when he is weak, then he is strong.

1 <i>It is not expedient for me doubtless to glory. I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.</i>	It is not really profitable for me to boast. Nevertheless, I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.
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| <p>2 <i>I knew a man in Christ above fourteen years ago, (whether in the body, I cannot tell; or whether out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;) such an one caught up to the third heaven.</i></p> <p>3 <i>And I knew such a man, (whether in the body, or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;)</i></p> <p>4 <i>How that he was caught up into paradise, and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter.</i></p> <p>5 <i>Of such an one will I glory: yet of myself I will not glory, but in mine infirmities.</i></p> <p>6 <i>For though I would desire to glory, I shall not be a fool; for I will say the truth: but now I forbear, lest any man should think of me above that which he seeth me to be, or that he heareth of me.</i></p> | <p>I knew a man in Christ over fourteen years ago — whether in the body, I cannot tell; or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knows — such a one was caught up to the third heaven.</p> <p>And I knew such a man — whether in the body or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knows —</p> <p>how He was caught up into paradise and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter.</p> <p>Of such a one I will boast; yet of myself I will not boast, except in my weaknesses.</p> <p>For though I might wish to boast, I would not be a fool — for I would be speaking the truth. But I refrain, so that no one will think of me more highly than what he sees in me or hears from me.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Thorn in the flesh** — A painful, persistent affliction. Paul does not say what his "thorn" was — it may have been a physical ailment, an opposition, or some other ongoing trouble. The lesson is not what the thorn was, but what it did: it kept Paul humble and made him lean wholly on the sufficient grace of Christ.

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| <p>7 <i>And lest I should be exalted above measure through the abundance of the revelations, there was given to me a thorn in the flesh, the messenger of Satan to buffet me, lest I should be exalted above measure.</i></p> <p>8 <i>For this thing I besought the Lord thrice, that it might depart from me.</i></p> | <p>And to keep me from being exalted above measure through the abundance of the revelations, there was given to me a thorn in the flesh — a messenger of Satan to buffet me — so I would not be exalted above measure.</p> <p>Three times I pleaded with the Lord that it might depart from me.</p> |
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- 9 *And he said unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in weakness. Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.* And He said unto me, My grace is sufficient for you: for my strength is made perfect in weakness. Therefore most gladly will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.
- 10 *Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses for Christ's sake: for when I am weak, then am I strong.* Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses for Christ's sake — for when I am weak, then am I strong.
- 11 *I am become a fool in glorying; ye have compelled me: for I ought to have been commended of you: for in nothing am I behind the very chiefest apostles, though I be nothing.* I have become a fool in boasting; You compelled me. For I ought to have been commended by You, since in nothing am I behind the very chiefest apostles, though I am nothing.
- 12 *Truly the signs of an apostle were wrought among you in all patience, in signs, and wonders, and mighty deeds.* Truly the signs of an apostle were performed among You in all patience, in signs and wonders and mighty deeds.
- 13 *For what is it wherein ye were inferior to other churches, except it be that I myself was not burdensome to you? forgive me this wrong.* For in what way were You inferior to the other churches, except that I myself was not a burden to You? Forgive me this wrong.
- 14 *Behold, the third time I am ready to come to you; and I will not be burdensome to you: for I seek not yours, but you: for the children ought not to lay up for the parents, but the parents for the children.* Now for the third time I am ready to come to You; and I will not be a burden to You, for I seek not Yours, but You. For the children ought not to lay up for the parents, but the parents for the children.
- 15 *And I will very gladly spend and be spent for you; though the more abundantly I love you, the less I be loved.* And I will most gladly spend and be spent for You — though the more abundantly I love You, the less I am loved.

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| <p>16 <i>But be it so, I did not burden you: nevertheless, being crafty, I caught you with guile.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Did I make a gain of you by any of them whom I sent unto you?</i></p> <p>18 <i>I desired Titus, and with him I sent a brother. Did Titus make a gain of you? walked we not in the same spirit? walked we not in the same steps?</i></p> <p>19 <i>Again, think ye that we excuse ourselves unto you? we speak before God in Christ: but we do all things, dearly beloved, for your edifying.</i></p> <p>20 <i>For I fear, lest, when I come, I shall not find you such as I would, and that I shall be found unto you such as ye would not: lest there be debates, envyings, wraths, strifes, backbitings, whisperings, swellings, tumults:</i></p> <p>21 <i>And lest, when I come again, my God will humble me among you, and that I shall bewail many which have sinned already, and have not repented of the uncleanness and fornication and lasciviousness which they have committed.</i></p> | <p>But be it so: I did not burden You. Nevertheless — they say — being crafty, I caught You with guile.</p> <p>Did I take advantage of You through any of those I sent to You?</p> <p>I urged Titus, and with him I sent a brother. Did Titus take advantage of you? Did we not walk in the same spirit? Did we not walk in the same steps?</p> <p>Again, do You think we are excusing ourselves to You? We speak before God in Christ. But all things, dearly beloved, are for Your building up.</p> <p>For I fear that when I come, I shall not find You as I wish, and that I shall be found by You not as You wish — that there may be quarrels, envyings, outbursts of wrath, strifes, backbitings, whisperings, swellings, tumults;</p> <p>and that when I come again, my God may humble me among You, and I shall mourn over many who have sinned before and have not repented of the uncleanness, fornication, and lasciviousness which they have committed.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Gal 1:12
- v2 — Acts 22:17; 1 Thess 4:17; Ezek 8:1-3; 2 Cor 11:11; Rev 4:2
- v7 — Num 33:55; Judg 2:3; 2 Chr 32:25-26; Gen 32:31; Gal 4:13
- v8 — Heb 5:7; Matt 26:39-44; 1 Sam 15:11; Ps 77:2-11; 2 Sam 12:16-18
- v9 — Phil 4:13; 2 Cor 12:10; Isa 40:29-31; Eph 3:16; Josh 1:9

- v10 — 2 Cor 12:9; Eph 6:10; Rom 5:3; 2 Cor 13:4; Jas 1:2
- v13 — 1 Cor 9:6; 1 Cor 9:12
- v14 — Prov 19:14; Gen 24:35-36; 1 Cor 10:33; Gen 31:14-15; 1 Cor 10:24
- v15 — 1 Thess 2:8; 2 Cor 1:6; Col 1:24; Phil 2:17; 2 Tim 2:10
- v18 — 2 Cor 8:6
- v19 — Rom 9:1
- v20 — 1 Pet 2:1; Gal 5:19-21

Chapter 13

Paul warns that on his third visit he will not spare those who continue in sin, and urges the Corinthians to examine themselves to see whether they are in the faith. He closes with a prayer for their perfection and the benediction: "The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all."

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| 1 | <i>This is the third time I am coming to you. In the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word be established.</i> | This will be the third time I am coming to You. "In the mouth of two or three witnesses every word shall be established." |
| 2 | <i>I told you before, and foretell you, as if I were present, the second time; and being absent now I write to them which heretofore have sinned, and to all other, that, if I come again, I will not spare:</i> | I have already warned You, and as if present the second time I now warn You while still absent — those who have sinned before, and all the rest — that if I come again, I will not spare. |
| 3 | <i>Since ye seek a proof of Christ speaking in me, which to you-ward is not weak, but is mighty in you.</i> | You are demanding a proof that Christ is speaking in me — He who is not weak toward you, but mighty in you. |
| 4 | <i>For though he was crucified through weakness, yet he liveth by the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but we shall live with him by the power of God toward you.</i> | For though He was crucified in weakness, yet He lives by the power of God. We also are weak in Him, but we shall live with Him by the power of God toward You. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Reprobate** (REH-pruh-bayt) — Failed, rejected, disqualified after testing. The Greek word was used of metal that did not pass the assay test. To be "reprobate" is to be exposed as counterfeit — a Christian whose claim to faith does not stand up under examination.

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| 5 | <i>Examine yourselves, whether ye be in the faith; prove your own selves. Know ye not your own selves, how that Jesus Christ is in you, except ye be reprobates?</i> | Examine yourselves, whether You be in the faith; test Your own selves. Do You not know Your own selves — that Jesus Christ is in You, unless You be reprobates? |
| 6 | <i>But I trust that ye shall know that we are not reprobates.</i> | But I trust that You shall know that we are not reprobates. |
| 7 | <i>Now I pray to God that ye do no evil; not that we should appear approved, but that ye should do that which is honest, though we be as reprobates.</i> | Now I pray to God that You do no evil — not that we should appear approved, but that You should do what is honest, even though we should seem as reprobates. |
| 8 | <i>For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth.</i> | For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth. |
| 9 | <i>For we are glad, when we are weak, and ye are strong: and this also we wish, even your perfection.</i> | For we are glad when we are weak and You are strong. And this also we pray for: Your perfecting. |
| 10 | <i>Therefore I write these things being absent, lest being present I should use sharpness, according to the power which the Lord hath given me to edification, and not to destruction.</i> | Therefore I write these things while absent, so that when present I may not have to be severe, according to the authority which the Lord has given me — for building up, and not for tearing down. |
| 11 | <i>Finally, brethren, farewell. Be perfect, be of good comfort, be of one mind, live in peace; and the God of love and peace shall be with you.</i> | Finally, brothers, farewell. Be perfect, be of good comfort, be of one mind, live in peace — and the God of love and peace shall be with You. |
| 12 | <i>Greet one another with an holy kiss.</i> | Greet one another with a holy kiss. |
| 13 | <i>All the saints salute you.</i> | All the saints greet You. |
| 14 | <i>The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen.</i> | The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen. |
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Words in this chapter:**Cross-References:**

- v1** — Matt 18:16; Deut 19:15; Deut 17:6; John 8:17-18; Num 35:30
- v2** — 2 Cor 1:23
- v3** — Matt 10:20
- v4** — 1 Pet 3:18; Rom 6:4; 2 Cor 10:3-4; Rom 6:8-11; 2 Tim 2:11-12
- v5** — Lam 3:40; 1 Cor 11:28; Ps 139:23-24; 1 Cor 9:27; Rev 2:5
- v7** — Jas 1:12
- v8** — Prov 21:30; Mark 9:39; Acts 4:28-30
- v9** — 2 Cor 13:11; 1 Cor 4:10; 1 Thess 3:10; 1 Pet 5:10
- v10** — 2 Cor 10:8; 2 Cor 2:3
- v11** — Heb 12:14; Rom 12:16; 1 Cor 1:10; Rom 15:33; Mark 9:50
- v12** — Rom 16:16; 1 Pet 5:14
- v14** — Eph 2:22; Rom 5:5; Rom 16:20; 1 Cor 16:23; Jude 1:21

Galatians

Author: Paul the apostle — one of the most personally intense of his letters; he writes with urgency and at one point anger at a church he founded being led astray.

Date written: c. AD 48–49 (early date) or c. AD 53–55 (later date); possibly the earliest of Paul's letters if written before the Jerusalem Council of Acts 15.

Written to: The churches of Galatia — a region in central Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Paul had planted congregations on his first missionary journey.

Setting: After Paul left, Jewish-Christian teachers (Judaizers) entered the Galatian churches insisting that Gentile believers must be circumcised and keep the Mosaic law in addition to faith in Christ. Paul writes in alarm: this is not a minor adjustment but a different gospel entirely.

Where this sits historically: Written under Claudius (early date) or early Nero (later date), at the dawn of the Gentile mission and either just before or just after the Jerusalem Council of Acts 15 settled the question of circumcision.

Contemporaries: Peter, Barnabas, James the brother of the Lord, and Titus all appear in the letter's narrative, with the Jerusalem Council taking place around the same window.

Big themes:

- Justification by faith alone — the Judaizers are perverting the gospel; a man is not justified "by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ" (2:16)
- No other gospel — Paul pronounces a double curse on anyone who preaches a different gospel, even if an angel preaches it
- Freedom in Christ — believers are no longer under the law as a covenant of obligation; Christ has set them free
- The fruit of the Spirit — chapter 5 contrasts walking in the flesh with walking in the Spirit, listing the nine-fold fruit that the Spirit produces
- The cross — "God forbid that I should glory, save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ" (6:14)

Key passages: Gal 1:8–9; 2:16; 2:20; 3:13; 5:22–23

How it fits: Galatians is Romans in miniature — compressed, urgent, and personal. Luther called it his "Katie von Bora" (his dear wife). It is the Magna Carta of Christian liberty, the clearest NT statement that salvation is by faith apart from works of law. Every time the church drifts toward works-righteousness, Galatians is the corrective.

Chapter 1

Paul marvels that the Galatians are so quickly turning to a different gospel and pronounces a curse on anyone who preaches another gospel than what they received. He defends his apostleship, declaring that the gospel he preaches came not from man but by the revelation of Jesus Christ.

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| 1 <i>Paul, an apostle, (not of men, neither by man, but by Jesus Christ, and God the Father, who raised him from the dead;)</i> | Paul, an apostle — not appointed by men nor through any man, but through Jesus Christ and God the Father, who raised Him from the dead— |
| 2 <i>And all the brethren which are with me, unto the churches of Galatia:</i> | and all the brothers with me, to the churches of Galatia: |

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Grace* (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift you could never earn or deserve. Paul uses grace as his opening word in every letter because it sums up the entire gospel — God gives freely, not because of anything we do, but because of who He is.

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| 3 <i>Grace be to you and peace from God the Father, and from our Lord Jesus Christ,</i> | Grace and peace to You from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ, |
| 4 <i>Who gave himself for our sins, that he might deliver us from this present evil world, according to the will of God and our Father:</i> | who gave Himself for our sins in order to deliver us from this present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father— |
| 5 <i>To whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.</i> | to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen. |
| 6 <i>I marvel that ye are so soon removed from him that called you into the grace of Christ unto another gospel:</i> | I marvel that You are so soon removed from Him who called You into the grace of Christ to another gospel— |
| 7 <i>Which is not another; but there be some that trouble you, and would pervert the gospel of Christ.</i> | which is really no gospel at all. Evidently some people are throwing You into confusion and are trying to distort the gospel of Christ. |
| 8 <i>But though we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel unto you than that which we have preached unto you, let him be accursed.</i> | But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel other than the one we preached to You, let Him be eternally condemned! |

- 9 *As we said before, so say I now again, If any man preach any other gospel unto you than that ye have received, let him be accursed.* As we have already said, so now I say again: if anyone is preaching to you a gospel contrary to what You received, let Him be eternally condemned!
- 10 *For do I now persuade men, or God? or do I seek to please men? for if I yet pleased men, I should not be the servant of Christ.* Am I now trying to win the approval of men, or of God? Am I trying to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ.
- 11 *But I certify you, brethren, that the gospel which was preached of me is not after man.* I want You to know, brothers, that the gospel I preached is not of human origin.
- 12 *For I neither received it of man, neither was I taught it, but by the revelation of Jesus Christ.* I did not receive it from any man, nor was I taught it; rather, I received it by a revelation from Jesus Christ.
- 13 *For ye have heard of my conversation in time past in the Jews' religion, how that beyond measure I persecuted the church of God, and wasted it:* For You have heard of my former way of life in Judaism — how intensely I persecuted the church of God and tried to destroy it.
- 14 *And profited in the Jews' religion above many my equals in mine own nation, being more exceedingly zealous of the traditions of my fathers.* I was advancing in Judaism beyond many of my own age among my people and was extremely zealous for the traditions of my fathers.
- 15 *But when it pleased God, who separated me from my mother's womb, and called me by his grace,* But when God, Who set me apart from birth and called me by His grace, was pleased
- 16 *To reveal his Son in me, that I might preach him among the heathen; immediately I conferred not with flesh and blood:* to reveal His Son in me so that I might preach Him among the Gentiles, my immediate response was not to consult any human being.
- 17 *Neither went I up to Jerusalem to them which were apostles before me; but I went into Arabia, and returned again unto Damascus.* I did not go up to Jerusalem to see those who were apostles before me, but I went into Arabia and later returned to Damascus.

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| 18 | <i>Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to see Peter, and abode with him fifteen days.</i> | Then after three years, I went up to Jerusalem to visit Cephas and stayed with Him fifteen days. |
| 19 | <i>But other of the apostles saw I none, save James the Lord's brother.</i> | I saw none of the other apostles — only James, the Lord's brother. |
| 20 | <i>Now the things which I write unto you, behold, before God, I lie not.</i> | I assure You before God that what I am writing You is no lie. |
| 21 | <i>Afterwards I came into the regions of Syria and Cilicia;</i> | Then I went to Syria and Cilicia. |
| 22 | <i>And was unknown by face unto the churches of Judaea which were in Christ:</i> | I was personally unknown to the churches of Judea that are in Christ. |
| 23 | <i>But they had heard only, That he which persecuted us in times past now preacheth the faith which once he destroyed.</i> | They only heard the report: "The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the faith he once tried to destroy." |
| 24 | <i>And they glorified God in me.</i> | And they praised God because of me. |

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Gal 1:11-12; 1 Cor 1:1; Acts 9:15-16; Rom 1:1; Rev 1:5
v4 — Matt 20:28; Rom 4:25; Gal 2:20; 1 Pet 2:24; 1 John 5:19-20
v6 — 2 Cor 11:4; Gal 5:7-8; Isa 29:13; Ps 106:13; Gal 3:1-5
v7 — Acts 15:24; Rom 16:17-18; Gal 5:10; 2 Cor 11:13; Acts 15:1-5
v8 — 2 Cor 11:13-14; Gal 1:9; Rev 22:18-19; 1 Cor 16:22; Rom 9:3
v9 — Rom 16:17; Prov 30:6; Deut 4:2; Rev 22:18-19; Deut 12:32-13:11
v10 — 1 Thess 2:4; Acts 5:29; Eph 6:6; Jas 4:4; Matt 22:16
v11 — Gal 1:1; Eph 3:3-8; 1 Cor 2:9-10; 1 Cor 11:23
v12 — Gal 1:16; 1 Cor 2:10; Gal 1:1; 2 Cor 12:1
v13 — 1 Cor 15:9; Acts 22:3-5; Acts 8:3; Acts 26:4-5
v14 — Col 2:8; Acts 26:5; Phil 3:4-6; Acts 22:3
v15 — Jer 1:5; Isa 49:5; Isa 49:1; 2 Tim 1:9; Eph 1:5

Chapter 2

Paul recounts going up to Jerusalem where the apostles added nothing to his gospel, and how he withstood Peter to his face at Antioch for withdrawing from the Gentiles. He declares that a man is not justified by the works of the law but by the faith of Jesus Christ, and that he is crucified with Christ — the life he now lives, he lives by the faith of the Son of God.

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| 1 | <i>Then fourteen years after I went up again to Jerusalem with Barnabas, and took Titus with me also.</i> | Then after fourteen years, I went up again to Jerusalem, this time with Barnabas. I took Titus along also. |
| 2 | <i>And I went up by revelation, and communicated unto them that gospel which I preach among the Gentiles, but privately to them which were of reputation, lest by any means I should run, or had run, in vain.</i> | I went in response to a revelation and set before them the gospel that I preach among the Gentiles. But I did this privately with those held in high esteem, for fear that I was running or had run my race in vain. |
| 3 | <i>But neither Titus, who was with me, being a Greek, was compelled to be circumcised:</i> | Yet not even Titus, who was with me, was compelled to be circumcised, even though he was a Greek. |
| 4 | <i>And that because of false brethren unawares brought in, who came in privily to spy out our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus, that they might bring us into bondage:</i> | This matter arose because some false brothers had been secretly brought in. They crept in to spy out the freedom we have in Christ Jesus, wanting to bring us into slavery. |
| 5 | <i>To whom we gave place by subjection, no, not for an hour; that the truth of the gospel might continue with you.</i> | We did not give in to them for a moment, so that the truth of the gospel might remain with You. |
| 6 | <i>But of these who seemed to be somewhat, (whatsoever they were, it maketh no matter to me: God accepteth no man's person:) they in conference added nothing to me:</i> | As for those who were held in high esteem — whatever they were makes no difference to me; God does not show favoritism — they added nothing to my message. |
| 7 | <i>But contrariwise, when they saw that the gospel of the uncircumcision was committed unto me, as the gospel of the circumcision was unto Peter;</i> | On the contrary, they recognized that I had been entrusted with the task of preaching the gospel to the uncircumcised, just as Peter had been to the circumcised. |

- 8 *(For he that wrought effectually in Peter to the apostleship of the circumcision, the same was mighty in me toward the Gentiles:)* For God Who worked through Peter as an apostle to the circumcised also worked through me as an apostle to the Gentiles.
- 9 *And when James, Cephas, and John, who seemed to be pillars, perceived the grace that was given unto me, they gave to me and Barnabas the right hands of fellowship; that we should go unto the heathen, and they unto the circumcision.* James, Cephas, and John, those regarded as pillars, gave me and Barnabas the right hand of fellowship when they recognized the grace given to me. They agreed that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcised.
- 10 *Only they would that we should remember the poor; the same which I also was forward to do.* All they asked was that we should continue to remember the poor, the very thing I had been eager to do all along.
- 11 *But when Peter was come to Antioch, I withstood him to the face, because he was to be blamed.* But when Peter came to Antioch, I withstood him to the face, because he was to be blamed.
- 12 *For before that certain came from James, he did eat with the Gentiles: but when they were come, he withdrew and separated himself, fearing them which were of the circumcision.* For before certain men came from James, he used to eat with the Gentiles. But when they arrived, he began to draw back and separate himself, fearing those of the circumcision group.
- 13 *And the other Jews dissembled likewise with him; insomuch that Barnabas also was carried away with their dissimulation.* The other Jews joined him in his hypocrisy, so that by their hypocrisy even Barnabas was led astray.
- 14 *But when I saw that they walked not uprightly according to the truth of the gospel, I said unto Peter before them all, If thou, being a Jew, livest after the manner of Gentiles, and not as do the Jews, why compellest thou the Gentiles to live as do the Jews?* When I saw that they were not acting in line with the truth of the gospel, I said to Cephas in front of them all: "You are a Jew, yet you live like a Gentile and not like a Jew. How is it, then, that you force Gentiles to follow Jewish customs?"

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| 15 <i>We who are Jews by nature, and not sinners of the Gentiles,</i> | We who are Jews by birth and not sinful Gentiles |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Justified** (JUS-tih-fide) — declared not guilty by God; legally counted as righteous because of Christ. To be justified is not to be made morally perfect — it is to be declared innocent in God's courtroom. God counts Christ's perfect record as yours the moment you believe.

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| 16 <i>Knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ, even we have believed in Jesus Christ, that we might be justified by the faith of Christ, and not by the works of the law: for by the works of the law shall no flesh be justified.</i> | know that a person is not justified by works of the law but through faith in Jesus Christ. So we also have believed in Christ Jesus, in order to be justified by faith in Christ and not by works of the law — because by works of the law no flesh will be justified. |
| 17 <i>But if, while we seek to be justified by Christ, we ourselves also are found sinners, is therefore Christ the minister of sin? God forbid.</i> | But if, in seeking to be justified in Christ, we ourselves are also found to be sinners, does that mean Christ promotes sin? Absolutely not! |
| 18 <i>For if I build again the things which I destroyed, I prove myself a transgressor.</i> | If I rebuild what I tore down, I prove that I am a transgressor. |
| 19 <i>For I through the law am dead to the law, that I might live unto God.</i> | For through the law I died to the law, so that I might live to God. |
| 20 <i>I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me.</i> | I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me. The life I now live in the body I live by faith in the Son of God, Who loved me and gave Himself for me. |
| 21 <i>I do not frustrate the grace of God: for if righteousness come by the law, then Christ is dead in vain.</i> | I do not set aside the grace of God. For if righteousness could be gained through the law, Christ died for nothing! |

Words in this chapter:

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Gal 2:6; Phil 2:16; 1 Thess 3:5
- v4 — Gal 5:1; Jude 1:4; 1 John 4:1; 2 Pet 2:1-2; 2 Cor 11:26
- v6 — Gal 2:2; Acts 10:34; Rom 2:11; 2 Cor 12:11
- v7 — 1 Thess 2:4; Acts 9:15; 1 Tim 2:7; Gal 1:16
- v10 — 1 John 3:17; Acts 24:17; Heb 13:16; 2 Cor 8:1-9; 1 Cor 16:1-2
- v12 — Acts 10:28; Luke 15:2; Acts 11:2-3; Eph 3:6
- v15 — Eph 2:3; Titus 3:3; Rom 3:9; Eph 2:11-12
- v16 — Phil 3:9; Ps 143:2; Rom 3:19-28; 1 Pet 1:18-21; Rom 9:30
- v17 — Rom 6:1-2; 1 John 3:8-10; 1 John 3:5; Gal 2:15
- v19 — Rom 7:4; Rom 6:2; 1 Thess 5:10; 2 Cor 5:15; Rom 6:11
- v20 — Gal 5:24; 2 Cor 5:15; Rom 6:4-6; Col 3:3-4; 2 Cor 4:10-11
- v21 — Rom 11:6; Gal 3:21; Heb 7:11; 1 Cor 15:14; Gal 2:16

Chapter 3

Paul rebukes the foolish Galatians, asking whether they received the Spirit by the works of the law or by the hearing of faith. He argues that the law was a schoolmaster to bring us to Christ, that the promise to Abraham came through faith, and that in Christ there is neither Jew nor Greek, bond nor free, male nor female — all are one in Christ Jesus.

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| 1 | <i>O foolish Galatians, who hath bewitched you, that ye should not obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ hath been evidently set forth, crucified among you?</i> | O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched You, that You should not obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ has been clearly set forth, crucified among You? |
| 2 | <i>This only would I learn of you, Received ye the Spirit by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith?</i> | I would like to learn just one thing from You: Did You receive the Spirit by works of the law, or by believing what You heard? |
| 3 | <i>Are ye so foolish? having begun in the Spirit, are ye now made perfect by the flesh?</i> | Are You so foolish? After beginning by means of the Spirit, are You now trying to finish by means of the flesh? |
| 4 | <i>Have ye suffered so many things in vain? if it be yet in vain.</i> | Have You experienced so much in vain — if it really was in vain? |

- 5 *He therefore that ministereth to you the Spirit, and worketh miracles among you, doeth he it by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith?* So again I ask: does God give You His Spirit and work miracles among You by the works of the law, or by Your believing what You heard?
- 6 *Even as Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him for righteousness.* So also: "Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to Him for righteousness."
- 7 *Know ye therefore that they which are of faith, the same are the children of Abraham.* Understand, then, that those who have faith are children of Abraham.
- 8 *And the scripture, foreseeing that God would justify the heathen through faith, preached before the gospel unto Abraham, saying, In thee shall all nations be blessed.* Scripture foresaw that God would justify the Gentiles by faith, and announced the gospel in advance to Abraham: "All nations will be blessed through you."
- 9 *So then they which be of faith are blessed with faithful Abraham.* So those who rely on faith are blessed along with Abraham, the man of faith.
- 10 *For as many as are of the works of the law are under the curse: for it is written, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law to do them.* For all who rely on works of the law are under a curse, as it is written: "Cursed is everyone who does not continue to do everything written in the Book of the Law."
- 11 *But that no man is justified by the law in the sight of God, it is evident: for, The just shall live by faith.* Clearly no one who relies on the law is justified before God, because "the righteous will live by faith."
- 12 *And the law is not of faith: but, The man that doeth them shall live in them.* The law is not based on faith; on the contrary, it says, "The person who does these things will live by them."
- 13 *Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us: for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree:* Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us — for it is written: "Cursed is every one that hangs on a tree."

- 14 *That the blessing of Abraham might come on the Gentiles through Jesus Christ; that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.* He redeemed us in order that the blessing given to Abraham might come to the Gentiles through Christ Jesus, so that by faith we might receive the promise of the Spirit.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. A covenant is stronger than a contract — it is an unbreakable vow. Paul's point here is that God's covenant with Abraham cannot be cancelled by the law that came 430 years later.

- 15 *Brethren, I speak after the manner of men; Though it be but a man's covenant, yet if it be confirmed, no man disannulleth, or addeth thereto.* Brothers and sisters, let me take an example from everyday life. Just as no one can set aside or add to a human covenant that has been duly established, so it is in this case.
- 16 *Now to Abraham and his seed were the promises made. He saith not, And to seeds, as of many; but as of one, And to thy seed, which is Christ.* The promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed. Scripture does not say "and to seeds," meaning many people, but "and to Your seed," meaning one person, who is Christ.
- 17 *And this I say, that the covenant, that was confirmed before of God in Christ, the law, which was four hundred and thirty years after, cannot disannul, that it should make the promise of none effect.* What I mean is this: the law, introduced 430 years later, does not set aside the covenant previously established by God and thus do away with the promise.
- 18 *For if the inheritance be of the law, it is no more of promise: but God gave it to Abraham by promise.* For if the inheritance depends on the law, then it no longer depends on the promise. But God in His grace gave it to Abraham through a promise.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (tranz-GRESH-un) — crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. It is stronger than just "doing wrong" — it means you knew where the boundary was and stepped over it deliberately. The law made Israel's transgressions plain and visible.

- 19 *Wherefore then serveth the law? It was added because of transgressions, till the seed should come to whom the promise was made; and it was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator.* Why then was the law given? It was added because of transgressions until the Seed to whom the promise referred had come. The law was given through angels and entrusted to a mediator.
- 20 *Now a mediator is not a mediator of one, but God is one.* A mediator, however, implies more than one party; but God is one.
- 21 *Is the law then against the promises of God? God forbid: for if there had been a law given which could have given life, verily righteousness should have been by the law.* Is the law, therefore, opposed to the promises of God? Not at all! For if a law had been given that could impart life, then righteousness would certainly have come by the law.
- 22 *But the scripture hath concluded all under sin, that the promise by faith of Jesus Christ might be given to them that believe.* But Scripture has shut up everyone under sin, so that the promise by faith in Jesus Christ might be given to those who believe.
- 23 *But before faith came, we were kept under the law, shut up unto the faith which should afterwards be revealed.* Before this faith came, we were held in custody under the law, locked up until the faith that was to come would be revealed.
- 24 *Wherefore the law was our schoolmaster to bring us unto Christ, that we might be justified by faith.* Therefore the law was our schoolmaster to bring us to Christ, that we might be justified by faith.
- 25 *But after that faith is come, we are no longer under a schoolmaster.* But after faith has come, we are no longer under a schoolmaster.
- 26 *For ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus.* You are all children of God through faith in Christ Jesus.
- 27 *For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ.* For all of You who were baptized into Christ have put on Christ.

28	<i>There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither bond nor free, there is neither male nor female: for ye are all one in Christ Jesus.</i>	There is neither Jew nor Greek, neither slave nor free, neither male nor female, for You are all one in Christ Jesus.
29	<i>And if ye be Christ's, then are ye Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise.</i>	If You belong to Christ, then You are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise.

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Rom 10:16-17; Gal 3:14; Acts 15:8; Eph 1:13-14; Gal 3:5
- v6 — Gen 15:6; Rom 4:21-22; Jas 2:23; Rom 4:3-6; Rom 4:24
- v8 — Gen 12:3; Gen 22:18; Gen 28:14; Gen 18:18; Gen 26:4
- v10 — Deut 27:26; Rom 8:7; Deut 11:26-28; Rom 3:19-20; Jer 11:3
- v11 — Hab 2:4; Rom 1:17; Heb 10:38; Gal 2:16; Ps 130:3-4
- v13 — 1 Pet 2:24; Deut 21:23; Heb 9:12; Heb 9:15; 1 Pet 1:18-21
- v14 — Gal 3:28-29; 1 Cor 12:13; Eph 2:18; Ezek 36:26-27; Gal 3:2
- v16 — Gen 17:7-8; Rom 4:13; Luke 1:55; Gen 22:17-18; Gal 3:27-29
- v26 — Eph 1:5; 2 Cor 6:18; John 1:12-13; 1 John 3:1-2; Gal 4:5-6
- v27 — Rom 13:14; 1 Cor 12:13; Rom 6:3-4; 1 Pet 3:21; Eph 4:24
- v28 — 1 Cor 12:12-13; Col 3:11; Rom 3:29-30; Gal 5:6; Rom 10:12-15
- v29 — Eph 3:6; Rom 9:7-8; Gal 3:7; Rom 8:17; Gal 4:22-31

Chapter 4

Paul explains that before faith came, we were kept under the law like children under tutors, but when the fulness of time came, God sent forth His Son to redeem those under the law so they might receive the adoption of sons. He uses the allegory of Sarah and Hagar to illustrate the difference between the bondage of the law and the freedom of the promise.

1	<i>Now I say, That the heir, as long as he is a child, differeth nothing from a servant, though he be lord of all;</i>	What I am saying is that as long as the heir is a child, he is no different from a servant, even though he is the owner of everything.
2	<i>But is under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the father.</i>	He is subject to guardians and trustees until the time set by his father.

- 3 *Even so we, when we were children, were in bondage under the elements of the world:* So also, when we were children, we were in slavery under the basic principles of the world.
- 4 *But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son, made of a woman, made under the law,* But when the time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law,
- 5 *To redeem them that were under the law, that we might receive the adoption of sons.* to redeem those under the law, that we might receive adoption as sons.
- 6 *And because ye are sons, God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, Abba, Father.* Because You are His sons, God sent the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, the Spirit Who calls out, "Abba, Father."
- 7 *Wherefore thou art no more a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.* Therefore You are no longer a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.
- 8 *Howbeit then, when ye knew not God, ye did service unto them which by nature are no gods.* Formerly, when You did not know God, You were enslaved to those who by nature are not gods.
- 9 *But now, after that ye have known God, or rather are known of God, how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements, whereunto ye desire again to be in bondage?* But now that You know God — or rather are known by God — how is it that You are turning back to those weak and miserable forces? Do You wish to be enslaved by them all over again?
- 10 *Ye observe days, and months, and times, and years.* You are observing special days, months, seasons, and years.
- 11 *I am afraid of you, lest I have bestowed upon you labour in vain.* I fear for You, that somehow I have wasted my efforts on You.
- 12 *Brethren, I beseech you, be as I am; for I am as ye are: ye have not injured me at all.* I plead with You, brothers and sisters, become like me, for I became like You. You did me no wrong.

- 13 *Ye know how through infirmity of the flesh I preached the gospel unto you at the first.* As You know, it was because of an illness that I first preached the gospel to You.
- 14 *And my temptation which was in my flesh ye despised not, nor rejected; but received me as an angel of God, even as Christ Jesus.* And my temptation which was in my flesh You did not despise or reject; but You received me as an angel of God, even as Christ Jesus.
- 15 *Where is then the blessedness ye spake of? for I bear you record, that, if it had been possible, ye would have plucked out your own eyes, and have given them to me.* Where, then, is Your blessing? I can testify that, if You could have done so, You would have torn out Your eyes and given them to me.
- 16 *Am I therefore become your enemy, because I tell you the truth?* Have I now become Your enemy by telling You the truth?
- 17 *They zealously affect you, but not well; yea, they would exclude you, that ye might affect them.* Those people are zealous to win You over, but for no good. What they want is to alienate You from us, so that You may have zeal for them.
- 18 *But it is good to be zealously affected always in a good thing, and not only when I am present with you.* It is good to be zealous, provided the purpose is good, and to be so always and not only when I am with You.
- 19 *My little children, of whom I travail in birth again until Christ be formed in you,* My dear children, for whom I am again in the pains of childbirth until Christ is formed in You—
- 20 *I desire to be present with you now, and to change my voice; for I stand in doubt of you.* how I wish I could be with You now and change my tone, because I am perplexed about You!
- 21 *Tell me, ye that desire to be under the law, do ye not hear the law?* Tell me, You who want to be under the law, are You not aware of what the law says?
- 22 *For it is written, that Abraham had two sons, the one by a bondmaid, the other by a freewoman.* For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by the slave woman and the other by the free woman.

- 23 *But he who was of the bondwoman was born after the flesh; but he of the freewoman was by promise.* His son by the slave woman was born in the ordinary way; but his son by the free woman was born as the result of a divine promise.
- 24 *Which things are an allegory: for these are the two covenants; the one from the mount Sinai, which gendereth to bondage, which is Agar.* These things are being taken figuratively: the women represent two covenants. One covenant is from Mount Sinai and bears children who are to be slaves — this is Hagar.
- 25 *For this Agar is mount Sinai in Arabia, and answereth to Jerusalem which now is, and is in bondage with her children.* For this Hagar is Mount Sinai in Arabia, and answers to the Jerusalem that now is, and is in bondage with her children.
- 26 *But Jerusalem which is above is free, which is the mother of us all.* But the Jerusalem that is above is free, and she is our mother.
- 27 *For it is written, Rejoice, thou barren that bearest not; break forth and cry, thou that travailest not: for the desolate hath many more children than she which hath an husband.* For it is written: "Rejoice, you who are childless. Break forth and cry aloud, you who are not in labor. For the desolate woman has more children than she who has a husband."
- 28 *Now we, brethren, as Isaac was, are the children of promise.* Now you, brothers and sisters, like Isaac, are children of promise.
- 29 *But as then he that was born after the flesh persecuted him that was born after the Spirit, even so it is now.* At that time the son born in the ordinary way persecuted the son born by the power of the Spirit. It is the same now.
- 30 *Nevertheless what saith the scripture? Cast out the bondwoman and her son: for the son of the bondwoman shall not be heir with the son of the freewoman.* Nevertheless what does the Scripture say? "Cast out the bondwoman and her son, for the son of the bondwoman shall not be heir with the son of the freewoman."
- 31 *So then, brethren, we are not children of the bondwoman, but of the free.* Therefore, brothers and sisters, we are not children of the slave woman, but of the free woman.

Words in this chapter:

- Abba** (*AB-ah*) — Aramaic word for 'Father' — an intimate address to God, showing the believer's adoption as God's child.
- Hagar** (*HAY-gar*) — Sarah's Egyptian handmaid — given to Abraham as a wife; mother of Ishmael; met the angel of the LORD at the well in the wilderness.
- Isaac** (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.
- Sinai** (*SY-ny*) — The mountain in the wilderness where God gave Moses the Ten Commandments — also called Horeb; the place of the covenant between God and Israel.

Cross-References:

- v3 — Col 2:20; Col 2:8; Gal 4:9; Gal 2:4; Gal 4:31-5:1
- v4 — Isa 7:14; Mark 1:15; John 1:14; Rom 1:3; Eph 1:10
- v5 — Heb 9:15; Eph 1:5; 1 Pet 1:18-20; Eph 1:7; Heb 9:12
- v6 — Rom 8:15-17; Rom 5:5; Rom 8:9; 2 Cor 3:17; Eph 2:18
- v7 — Gal 3:29-4:2; Rom 8:16-17; Gal 3:26; 1 Cor 3:21-23; Gal 4:5-6
- v8 — 1 Cor 8:4; Eph 2:11-12; 1 Thess 4:5; 2 Thess 1:8; 1 Thess 1:9
- v9 — 1 Cor 8:3; Gal 3:3; Rom 8:3; 1 John 5:20; 1 Chr 28:9
- v16 — Amos 5:10; Prov 9:8; John 8:45; Gal 5:7; Ps 141:5
- v19 — Eph 4:13; Rom 8:29; Rom 13:14; Eph 4:24; Col 4:12
- v26 — Heb 12:22; Rev 21:2; Phil 3:20; Rev 3:12; Mic 4:1-2
- v27 — Isa 54:1-5; Ps 113:9; Ruth 4:14-16; 1 Sam 2:5
- v30 — Gen 21:10-12; John 8:35; Rom 8:15-17

Chapter 5

Paul urges the Galatians to stand fast in the liberty of Christ and not to submit again to the yoke of bondage, warning that if they are circumcised as a requirement for salvation, Christ profits them nothing. He contrasts the works of the flesh — fornication, idolatry, hatred, and the like — with the fruit of the Spirit: love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, meekness, and temperance.

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Stand fast therefore in the liberty wherewith Christ hath made us free, and be not entangled again with the yoke of bondage.
- It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery.
- 2

Behold, I Paul say unto you, that if ye be circumcised, Christ shall profit you nothing.
- Mark my words! I, Paul, tell you that if you let yourselves be circumcised, Christ will be of no value to You at all.

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| 3 | <i>For I testify again to every man that is circumcised, that he is a debtor to do the whole law.</i> | Again I testify to every man who is circumcised that he is a debtor to do the whole law. |
| 4 | <i>Christ is become of no effect unto you, whosoever of you are justified by the law; ye are fallen from grace.</i> | You who are trying to be justified by the law have been alienated from Christ; You have fallen away from grace. |
| 5 | <i>For we through the Spirit wait for the hope of righteousness by faith.</i> | For through the Spirit we eagerly await by faith the righteousness for which we hope. |
| 6 | <i>For in Jesus Christ neither circumcision availeth any thing, nor uncircumcision; but faith which worketh by love.</i> | For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision has any value. The only thing that counts is faith expressing itself through love. |
| 7 | <i>Ye did run well; who did hinder you that ye should not obey the truth?</i> | You were running a good race. Who cut in on You to keep You from obeying the truth? |
| 8 | <i>This persuasion cometh not of him that calleth you.</i> | That kind of persuasion does not come from the One who calls you. |
| 9 | <i>A little leaven leaveneth the whole lump.</i> | A little leaven leavens the whole lump. |
| 10 | <i>I have confidence in you through the Lord, that ye will be none otherwise minded: but he that troubleth you shall bear his judgment, whosoever he be.</i> | I am confident in the Lord that You will take no other view. The one who is throwing you into confusion will have to pay the penalty, whoever he may be. |
| 11 | <i>And I, brethren, if I yet preach circumcision, why do I yet suffer persecution? then is the offence of the cross ceased.</i> | Brothers and sisters, if I am still preaching circumcision, why am I still being persecuted? In that case the offense of the cross has been abolished. |
| 12 | <i>I would they were even cut off which trouble you.</i> | As for those who are disturbing You, I wish they would go the whole way and emasculate themselves! |

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| <p>13 <i>For, brethren, ye have been called unto liberty; only use not liberty for an occasion to the flesh, but by love serve one another.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For all the law is fulfilled in one word, even in this; Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.</i></p> <p>15 <i>But if ye bite and devour one another, take heed that ye be not consumed one of another.</i></p> <p>16 <i>This I say then, Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For the flesh lusteth against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh: and these are contrary the one to the other: so that ye cannot do the things that ye would.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But if ye be led of the Spirit, ye are not under the law.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Now the works of the flesh are manifest, which are these; Adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness,</i></p> <p>20 <i>Idolatry, witchcraft, hatred, variance, emulations, wrath, strife, seditions, heresies,</i></p> <p>21 <i>Envyings, murders, drunkenness, revellings, and such like: of the which I tell you before, as I have also told you in time past, that they which do such things shall not inherit the kingdom of God.</i></p> | <p>You, my brothers and sisters, were called to be free. But do not use Your freedom to indulge the flesh; rather, serve one another humbly in love.</p> <p>For the entire law is fulfilled in keeping this one command: "Love Your neighbor as Yourself."</p> <p>If You keep on biting and devouring each other, watch out or You will be destroyed by each other.</p> <p>So I say, walk by the Spirit, and You will not gratify the desires of the flesh.</p> <p>For the flesh desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are in conflict with each other, so that You are not to do whatever You want.</p> <p>But if You are led by the Spirit, You are not under the law.</p> <p>The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity, and debauchery;</p> <p>idolatry and witchcraft; hatred, discord, jealousy, fits of rage, selfish ambition, dissensions, factions;</p> <p>and envy, murders, drunkenness, carousing, and the like. I warn You, as I did before, that those who live like this will not inherit the kingdom of God.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient endurance with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. It is one of the nine fruits of the Spirit listed here. Longsuffering is not weakness — it is the strength to keep loving when you have every reason to give up.

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| 22 | <i>But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith,</i> | But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, |
| 23 | <i>Meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.</i> | meekness, temperance: against such there is no law. |
| 24 | <i>And they that are Christ's have crucified the flesh with the affections and lusts.</i> | Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. |
| 25 | <i>If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit.</i> | Since we live by the Spirit, let us keep in step with the Spirit. |
| 26 | <i>Let us not be desirous of vain glory, provoking one another, envying one another.</i> | Let us not become conceited, provoking and envying each other. |

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Cor 3:17; Gal 5:13; 1 Pet 2:16; Rom 6:14; John 8:32-36
- v4** — Rom 9:31-32; 2 Pet 2:20-22; Gal 2:21; Rom 11:6; Heb 12:15
- v13** — 1 Pet 2:16; 1 Cor 9:19; 1 Cor 8:9; Rom 15:1-2; Gal 5:14
- v14** — Matt 7:12; Lev 19:18; Gal 6:2; Mark 12:31; Rom 13:8-10
- v16** — Gal 5:24-25; Rom 8:12-14; Gal 6:8; Gal 5:19-21; Col 3:5-10
- v17** — Rom 8:13; Rom 8:5-8; John 3:6; Matt 26:41; Ps 119:20
- v19** — 1 Cor 6:9-10; Col 3:5-8; Matt 15:18-19; 1 Pet 4:2-4; Rev 21:8
- v21** — 1 Cor 6:9-10; Rom 8:13; Rom 13:13; Eph 5:5-6; 1 Cor 5:11
- v22** — Col 3:12-17; 1 Cor 13:4-7; John 15:5; Jas 3:17-18; John 15:2
- v24** — Rom 6:6; Rom 13:14; Rom 8:13; Gal 5:16-18; Rom 8:9
- v25** — Gal 5:16; Rom 8:4-5; Rom 8:2; John 6:63; 2 Cor 3:6
- v26** — Jas 3:14-16; Phil 2:1-3; Jas 4:16; 1 Cor 3:7; Gal 5:15

Chapter 6

Paul instructs believers to restore the fallen in meekness, to bear one another's burdens, and to do good to all men especially those of the household of faith. He warns not to be deceived — God is not mocked, for whatever a man sows, that shall he also reap — and closes by declaring that neither circumcision nor uncircumcision matters, but a new creature in Christ.

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| 1 | <i>Brethren, if a man be overtaken in a fault, ye which are spiritual, restore such an one in the spirit of meekness; considering thyself, lest thou also be tempted.</i> | Brothers, if a man is overtaken in a fault, you who are spiritual should restore such a one in the spirit of meekness, considering Yourself, lest You also be tempted. |
| 2 | <i>Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.</i> | Carry each other's burdens, and in this way You will fulfill the law of Christ. |
| 3 | <i>For if a man think himself to be something, when he is nothing, he deceiveth himself.</i> | If anyone thinks he is something when he is not, he deceives Himself. |
| 4 | <i>But let every man prove his own work, and then shall he have rejoicing in himself alone, and not in another.</i> | Each one should test his own actions. Then he can take pride in Himself alone, without comparing Himself to someone else. |
| 5 | <i>For every man shall bear his own burden.</i> | For each one should carry his own load. |
| 6 | <i>Let him that is taught in the word communicate unto him that teacheth in all good things.</i> | Nevertheless, the one who receives instruction in the word should share all good things with their instructor. |
| 7 | <i>Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap.</i> | Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatever a man sows, that shall he also reap. |
| 8 | <i>For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting.</i> | Whoever sows to please their flesh, from the flesh will reap destruction. Whoever sows to please the Spirit, from the Spirit will reap eternal life. |
| 9 | <i>And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.</i> | Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up. |

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| <p>10 <i>As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Ye see how large a letter I have written unto you with mine own hand.</i></p> <p>12 <i>As many as desire to make a fair shew in the flesh, they constrain you to be circumcised; only lest they should suffer persecution for the cross of Christ.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For neither they themselves who are circumcised keep the law; but desire to have you circumcised, that they may glory in your flesh.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But God forbid that I should glory, save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom the world is crucified unto me, and I unto the world.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth any thing, nor uncircumcision, but a new creature.</i></p> | <p>Therefore, as we have opportunity, let us do good to all people, especially to those who belong to the family of believers.</p> <p>See what large letters I use as I write to You with my own hand!</p> <p>Those who want to impress people by means of the flesh are trying to compel You to be circumcised. The only reason they do this is to avoid being persecuted for the cross of Christ.</p> <p>Not even those who are circumcised keep the law, yet they want You to be circumcised so that they may boast about Your circumcision in the flesh.</p> <p>May I never boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world.</p> <p>For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision avails anything, nor uncircumcision, but a new creature.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God's mercy means He withholds the wrath we have earned. Paul closes with this blessing — peace and mercy — as a summary of what God gives to all who walk by the rule of the gospel.

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| <p>16 <i>And as many as walk according to this rule, peace be on them, and mercy, and upon the Israel of God.</i></p> <p>17 <i>From henceforth let no man trouble me: for I bear in my body the marks of the Lord Jesus.</i></p> | <p>Peace and mercy to all who follow this rule — to the Israel of God.</p> <p>From now on, let no one trouble me, for I bear in my body the marks of the Lord Jesus.</p> |
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- 18 *Brethren, the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.* The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with Your spirit, brothers and sisters. Amen.
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Words in this chapter:

faith — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rom 15:1; 2 Tim 2:25; 2 Thess 3:15; Jas 5:19-20; Jude 1:22-23
v2 — Rom 15:1; 1 Thess 5:14; John 13:34; 1 John 4:21; Jas 2:8
v3 — Prov 26:12; 1 Cor 3:18; 1 Cor 8:2; Rom 12:3; 2 Cor 3:5
v4 — 2 Cor 13:5; Ps 26:2; 1 Cor 11:28; 2 Cor 11:12-13; 2 Cor 1:12
v6 — 1 Tim 5:17-18; Rom 15:27; Deut 12:19; 1 Cor 9:9-14; Matt 10:10
v7 — 2 Cor 9:6; Hos 10:12; Job 4:8; Rom 2:6-10; 1 Cor 15:33
v8 — Rom 8:13; Jas 3:18; 2 Pet 2:19; Hos 10:13; Job 4:8
v9 — 1 Cor 15:58; 2 Thess 3:13; Isa 40:30-31; Heb 10:35-39; Heb 12:3
v10 — Heb 13:16; Prov 3:27; 1 Thess 5:15; Titus 3:8; Matt 25:40
v14 — Rom 6:6; Jer 9:23-24; Gal 2:20; 1 Cor 2:2; Phil 3:3
v15 — 2 Cor 5:17; Col 3:10-11; Gal 5:6; Eph 2:10; Eph 4:24
v16 — Gal 3:29; Phil 3:3; Rom 9:6-8; Gal 3:7-9; 1 Pet 2:5-9

Ephesians

Author: Paul the apostle — a prisoner at the time of writing (3:1, 4:1, 6:20); one of the four "Prison Epistles" written during his Roman imprisonment.

Date written: c. AD 60–62, from Rome during Paul's first imprisonment.

Written to: The church at Ephesus, and possibly circulated to neighboring churches in Asia Minor.

Setting: Paul spent three years in Ephesus (Acts 19–20), his longest stay in any city. The church there was mature and well-taught. Writing from prison, Paul composes what many consider his most exalted letter — elevated in tone, sweeping in scope, almost entirely without personal corrections.

Where this sits historically: Written during Paul's first Roman imprisonment under Nero, while the apostle awaited trial in chains and Burrus or Tigellinus served as Praetorian Prefect.

Contemporaries: Tychicus carried this letter alongside Colossians and Philemon, while Luke, Timothy, Aristarchus, and Epaphras were with Paul in Rome and Peter ministered in the eastern provinces.

Big themes:

- Election and grace — God chose believers in Christ before the foundation of the world; salvation begins in eternity past with the Father's sovereign choice
- The church as the body of Christ — Ephesians contains the NT's richest ecclesiology; the church is Christ's body, His bride, His temple, and the fullness of Him who fills all in all
- Jew and Gentile united — the "middle wall of partition" between Jew and Gentile has been broken down; in Christ there is one new man
- Walking worthy — chapters 4–6 apply the theological foundation of chapters 1–3; knowing who you are in Christ determines how you live
- Spiritual warfare — the full armour of God (6:10–18) is needed because believers fight not against flesh and blood but against spiritual powers

Key passages: Eph 1:4–5; 2:8–9; 2:14; 4:4–6; 6:10–11

How it fits: Ephesians is the high-water mark of NT ecclesiology. It is the companion letter to Colossians, written at the same time and delivered by the same messenger. Where Romans answers "How is a man saved?", Ephesians answers "What has God made of those who are saved?" Together they are Paul's masterwork.

Chapter 1

Paul blesses God for choosing believers in Christ before the foundation of the world and predestinating them to the adoption of children according to the good pleasure of His will. He

prays that the Ephesians would know the hope of their calling, the riches of God's inheritance in the saints, and the exceeding greatness of His power toward those who believe.

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| <p>1 <i>Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints which are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:</i></p> | <p>Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints who are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift you could never earn or deserve. Ephesians is perhaps the deepest explanation of grace in all of Paul's letters. He will show that salvation, adoption, redemption, and eternal life all come purely by grace — not by anything we do.*

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| <p>2 <i>Grace be to you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> | <p>Grace and peace to You from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath blessed us with all spiritual blessings in heavenly places in Christ:</i></p> | <p>Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, Who has blessed us in the heavenly realms with every spiritual blessing in Christ.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>According as he hath chosen us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before him in love:</i></p> | <p>For He chose us in Him before the creation of the world to be holy and blameless in His sight in love.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself, according to the good pleasure of his will,</i></p> | <p>He predestined us for adoption as His sons through Jesus Christ, in accordance with His pleasure and will—</p> |
| <p>6 <i>To the praise of the glory of his grace, wherein he hath made us accepted in the beloved.</i></p> | <p>to the praise of the glory of His grace, by which He has made us accepted in the beloved.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (rih-DEM-shun) — *to buy back; to set free by paying a price. In the ancient world, a slave could be redeemed when someone paid the price to free them. Christ paid the price — His own blood — to redeem us from the slavery of sin and death.*

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| <p>7 <i>In whom we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of his grace;</i></p> | <p>In Him we have redemption through His blood — the forgiveness of sins — according to the riches of His grace</p> |
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| 8 | <i>Wherein he hath abounded toward us in all wisdom and prudence;</i> | that He lavished on us. With all wisdom and understanding, |
| 9 | <i>Having made known unto us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he hath purposed in himself:</i> | He made known to us the mystery of His will according to His good pleasure, which He purposed in Christ, |
| 10 | <i>That in the dispensation of the fulness of times he might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven, and which are on earth; even in him:</i> | to be put into effect when the times reach their fulfillment — to bring all things in heaven and on earth together under one head, even Christ. |
| 11 | <i>In whom also we have obtained an inheritance, being predestinated according to the purpose of him who worketh all things after the counsel of his own will:</i> | In Him we were also chosen, having been predestined according to the plan of Him who works out everything in conformity with the purpose of His will, |
| 12 | <i>That we should be to the praise of his glory, who first trusted in Christ.</i> | so that we, who were the first to put our hope in Christ, might be to the praise of His glory. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the old English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost seals every believer at the moment of salvation — He is God's mark of ownership, the guarantee that you belong to Him forever.*

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| 13 | <i>In whom ye also trusted, after that ye heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation: in whom also after that ye believed, ye were sealed with that holy Spirit of promise,</i> | In Him You also trusted, after You heard the word of truth, the gospel of Your salvation. In Him also, after You believed, You were sealed with that Holy Spirit of promise, |
| 14 | <i>Which is the earnest of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, unto the praise of his glory.</i> | who is the earnest of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, to the praise of His glory. |
| 15 | <i>Wherefore I also, after I heard of your faith in the Lord Jesus, and love unto all the saints,</i> | For this reason, ever since I heard about Your faith in the Lord Jesus and Your love for all the saints, |

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| 16 <i>Cease not to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers;</i> | I have not stopped giving thanks for You, remembering You in my prayers. |
| 17 <i>That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him:</i> | I keep asking that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the glorious Father, may give You the Spirit of wisdom and revelation, so that You may know Him better. |
| 18 <i>The eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that ye may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the saints,</i> | I pray that the eyes of Your heart may be enlightened so that You may know the hope to which He has called You, the riches of His glorious inheritance in the saints, |
| 19 <i>And what is the exceeding greatness of his power to us-ward who believe, according to the working of his mighty power,</i> | and the incomparably great power toward us who believe. That power is like the working of His mighty strength, |
| 20 <i>Which he wrought in Christ, when he raised him from the dead, and set him at his own right hand in the heavenly places,</i> | which He exerted when He raised Christ from the dead and seated Him at His right hand in the heavenly realms, |
| 21 <i>Far above all principality, and power, and might, and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this world, but also in that which is to come:</i> | far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every name that is invoked — not only in the present age but also in the one to come. |
| 22 <i>And hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church,</i> | God placed all things under His feet and appointed Him to be head over everything for the church, |
| 23 <i>Which is his body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all.</i> | which is His body — the fullness of Him who fills everything in every way. |

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Cross-References:

- v3 — 1 Pet 1:3; 2 Cor 1:3; Eph 2:6; Gen 22:18; Rev 5:9-14
- v4 — 2 Tim 1:9; Rom 8:28-30; Eph 2:10; Matt 25:34; 1 Pet 2:9
- v5 — Rom 8:29-30; Eph 1:11; Gal 4:5-6; John 1:12; 1 John 3:1
- v6 — Rom 3:22-26; Col 1:13; Eph 1:12; Phil 4:19; Matt 3:17
- v7 — 1 Pet 2:24; Rom 3:24; Col 1:14; 1 John 1:7-9; 1 Pet 1:18-19
- v10 — Col 1:20; Phil 2:9-10; Gal 4:4; Dan 2:44; Mark 1:15
- v11 — Rom 8:28; 1 Pet 1:4; Isa 46:10-11; Eph 1:14; Eph 1:5
- v13 — 2 Cor 1:22; Eph 4:30; 2 Tim 2:19; 1 Thess 2:13; Gal 3:14
- v14 — 2 Cor 1:22; 2 Cor 5:5; Eph 4:30; Gal 4:6; Rom 8:15-17
- v17 — Isa 11:2; Jas 3:17-18; Col 1:9-10; Prov 2:5; 2 Pet 1:3
- v18 — Acts 26:18; 2 Cor 4:6; Luke 24:45; 1 John 3:1-3; Ps 119:18
- v19 — Phil 2:13; Eph 3:20; Col 2:12; Eph 6:10; Col 1:29

Chapter 2

Paul teaches that believers were dead in trespasses and sins but God, who is rich in mercy, quickened them together with Christ — by grace they are saved through faith, and that not of themselves, it is the gift of God, not of works. He declares that Christ has broken down the wall of partition between Jew and Gentile, making of the two one new man in Himself.

■ **WORD NOTE — Quickened** (*KWIK-end*) — made alive; spiritually brought from death to life by God. This is not physical resurrection — it is the moment God breathes new spiritual life into someone who was dead in sin. Only God can do this; no one can quicken themselves.

■ **WORD NOTE — Transgression** (*tranz-GRESH-un*) — crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. It is stronger than just "doing wrong" — it means stepping deliberately over a known boundary. Paul pairs it with "sins" to show the full depth of human guilt before God.

- 1 And you hath he quickened, who were dead in trespasses and sins; God quickened You — you who were dead in Your transgressions and sins,

- 2 *Wherein in time past ye walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that now worketh in the children of disobedience:* in which in time past you walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit who now works in the children of disobedience.
- 3 *Among whom also we all had our conversation in times past in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind; and were by nature the children of wrath, even as others.* Among whom we all also had our conduct in times past in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind, and were by nature the children of wrath, even as others.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. God's mercy means He withholds the wrath we have earned. Ephesians 2 is one of the greatest mercy passages in the Bible — we were dead, deserving wrath, and God responded with mercy and love.

- 4 *But God, who is rich in mercy, for his great love wherewith he loved us,* But because of His great love for us, God, Who is rich in mercy,
- 5 *Even when we were dead in sins, hath quickened us together with Christ, (by grace ye are saved;)* even when we were dead in sins, He quickened us together with Christ — it is by grace You have been saved.
- 6 *And hath raised us up together, and made us sit together in heavenly places in Christ Jesus:* And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with Him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus,
- 7 *That in the ages to come he might shew the exceeding riches of his grace in his kindness toward us through Christ Jesus.* in order that in the coming ages He might show the incomparable riches of His grace expressed in His kindness to us in Christ Jesus.
- 8 *For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:* For it is by grace You have been saved, through faith — and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God—
- 9 *Not of works, lest any man should boast.* not by works, so that no one can boast.

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| <p>10 <i>For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Wherefore remember, that ye being in time past Gentiles in the flesh, who are called Uncircumcision by that which is called the Circumcision in the flesh made by hands;</i></p> | <p>For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God has before ordained that we should walk in them.</p> <p>Therefore, remember that formerly You who are Gentiles by birth — called "uncircumcised" by those who call themselves "the circumcision" (which is done in the body by human hands)—</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. The Gentiles had been strangers to God's covenants — the promises made to Abraham, Moses, and David. Through Christ, they are now brought inside those promises.

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| <p>12 <i>That at that time ye were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope, and without God in the world:</i></p> <p>13 <i>But now in Christ Jesus ye who sometimes were far off are made nigh by the blood of Christ.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For he is our peace, who hath made both one, and hath broken down the middle wall of partition between us;</i></p> <p>15 <i>Having abolished in his flesh the enmity, even the law of commandments contained in ordinances; for to make in himself of twain one new man, so making peace;</i></p> <p>16 <i>And that he might reconcile both unto God in one body by the cross, having slain the enmity thereby:</i></p> | <p>remember that at that time You were separate from Christ, excluded from citizenship in Israel and foreigners to the covenants of the promise, without hope and without God in the world.</p> <p>But now in Christ Jesus You who once were far away have been brought near by the blood of Christ.</p> <p>For He is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of partition between us, by setting aside in His flesh the law with its commands and regulations. His purpose was to create in Himself one new humanity out of the two, thus making peace,</p> <p>and in one body to reconcile both of them to God through the cross, by which He put to death their hostility.</p> |
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| 17 | <i>And came and preached peace to you which were afar off, and to them that were nigh.</i> | He came and preached peace to You who were far away and peace to those who were near. |
| 18 | <i>For through him we both have access by one Spirit unto the Father.</i> | For through Him we both have access to the Father by one Spirit. |
| 19 | <i>Now therefore ye are no more strangers and foreigners, but fellowcitizens with the saints, and of the household of God;</i> | Now therefore You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and of the household of God, |
| 20 | <i>And are built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the chief corner stone;</i> | built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus Himself as the chief cornerstone. |
| 21 | <i>In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple in the Lord:</i> | In Him the whole building is joined together and rises to become a holy temple in the Lord. |
| 22 | <i>In whom ye also are builded together for an habitation of God through the Spirit.</i> | And in Him You too are being built together to become a dwelling place of God through the Spirit. |

Words in this chapter:

quicken — Made alive — spiritually brought from death to life by God; used for resurrection and spiritual rebirth.

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Col 2:13; Eph 2:5-6; Col 3:1-4; Eph 4:18; Rom 8:2
- v2** — Eph 6:12; 1 John 5:19; Eph 2:3; Col 3:6-7; John 12:31
- v4** — 1 Pet 1:3; Eph 1:7; Ps 86:15; Titus 3:4-7; Rom 5:8
- v5** — Rom 3:24; Eph 2:8; Rom 5:10; Rom 5:8; Acts 15:11
- v6** — Col 3:1-3; Eph 1:3; Rom 6:4-5; Col 2:12-13; John 17:21-26
- v8** — Rom 3:22-26; Eph 2:5; Rom 4:16; John 1:12-13; Rom 10:17
- v9** — 2 Tim 1:9; Rom 11:6; Titus 3:3-5; Rom 9:16; 1 Cor 1:29-31
- v10** — Phil 2:13; Col 1:10; Heb 13:21; 2 Cor 5:17; 2 Cor 9:8

v13 — Acts 2:39; Col 1:20-22; Col 1:13-14; Eph 2:19-22; 1 Cor 6:11

v14 — Gal 3:28; Col 3:15; Col 3:11; Eph 2:15; 1 Cor 12:12-13

v19 — Phil 3:20; 1 John 3:1; Gal 6:10; Gal 3:26-28; Eph 2:12

v20 — 1 Pet 2:4-5; Isa 28:16; 1 Pet 2:7-8; Ps 118:22; Matt 16:18

Chapter 3

Paul reveals the mystery hidden from past ages: that the Gentiles are fellow heirs with Israel, members of the same body, and partakers of the promise in Christ Jesus through the gospel. He prays that the Ephesians would be strengthened with might by the Spirit in the inner man and would know the love of Christ which passes knowledge.

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| 1 <i>For this cause I Paul, the prisoner of Jesus Christ for you Gentiles,</i> | For this reason I, Paul, the prisoner of Christ Jesus for the sake of You Gentiles— |
| 2 <i>If ye have heard of the dispensation of the grace of God which is given me to you-ward:</i> | Surely You have heard about the administration of God's grace that was given to me for You, |
| 3 <i>How that by revelation he made known unto me the mystery; (as I wrote afore in few words,</i> | that is, the mystery made known to me by revelation, as I have already written briefly. |
| 4 <i>Whereby, when ye read, ye may understand my knowledge in the mystery of Christ)</i> | In reading this, then, You will be able to understand my insight into the mystery of Christ, |
| 5 <i>Which in other ages was not made known unto the sons of men, as it is now revealed unto his holy apostles and prophets by the Spirit;</i> | which was not made known to people in other generations as it has now been revealed by the Spirit to God's holy apostles and prophets. |
| 6 <i>That the Gentiles should be fellowheirs, and of the same body, and partakers of his promise in Christ by the gospel:</i> | that the Gentiles should be fellow heirs, of the same body, and partakers of His promise in Christ through the gospel, |
| 7 <i>Whereof I was made a minister, according to the gift of the grace of God given unto me by the effectual working of his power.</i> | I became a servant of this gospel by the gift of God's grace given me through the working of His power. |

- 8 *Unto me, who am less than the least of all saints, is this grace given, that I should preach among the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ;* Although I am less than the least of all the Lord's people, this grace was given me: to preach to the Gentiles the boundless riches of Christ,
- 9 *And to make all men see what is the fellowship of the mystery, which from the beginning of the world hath been hid in God, who created all things by Jesus Christ:* and to make all men see what is the fellowship of the mystery, which from the beginning of the world has been hidden in God, Who created all things by Jesus Christ,
- 10 *To the intent that now unto the principalities and powers in heavenly places might be known by the church the manifold wisdom of God,* His intent was that now, through the church, the manifold wisdom of God should be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms,
- 11 *According to the eternal purpose which he purposed in Christ Jesus our Lord:* according to His eternal purpose that He accomplished in Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 12 *In whom we have boldness and access with confidence by the faith of him.* In Him and through faith in Him we may approach God with freedom and confidence.
- 13 *Wherefore I desire that ye faint not at my tribulations for you, which is your glory.* I ask You, therefore, not to be discouraged because of my sufferings for You, which are Your glory.
- 14 *For this cause I bow my knees unto the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,* For this reason I bow my knees to the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,
- 15 *Of whom the whole family in heaven and earth is named,* from whom every family in heaven and on earth derives its name.
- 16 *That he would grant you, according to the riches of his glory, to be strengthened with might by his Spirit in the inner man;* I pray that out of His glorious riches He may strengthen You with power through His Spirit in Your inner being,
- 17 *That Christ may dwell in your hearts by faith; that ye, being rooted and grounded in love,* so that Christ may dwell in Your hearts through faith. And I pray that You, being rooted and established in love,

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| 18 | <i>May be able to comprehend with all saints what is the breadth, and length, and depth, and height;</i> | may have power, together with all the Lord's people, to grasp how wide and long and high and deep is the love of Christ, |
| 19 | <i>And to know the love of Christ, which passeth knowledge, that ye might be filled with all the fulness of God.</i> | and to know this love that surpasses knowledge — that You may be filled to the measure of all the fullness of God. |
| 20 | <i>Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that worketh in us,</i> | Now to Him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to His power that is at work within us, |
| 21 | <i>Unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen.</i> | to Him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

v3 — Gal 1:12; Rom 16:25; Eph 3:9; Eph 1:9-11; Eph 3:4
v6 — Gal 3:26-29; 1 John 2:25; Gal 3:14; 1 John 1:3; Rom 8:15-17
v8 — 1 Cor 15:9; Col 1:27; 1 Tim 1:13; Eph 2:7; Eph 3:16
v10 — 1 Pet 1:12; Eph 6:12; 1 Cor 2:7; Rom 11:33; Eph 1:3
v12 — Rom 5:2; Eph 2:18; Heb 4:14-16; John 14:6; Heb 10:19-22
v14 — Ps 95:6; Eph 1:16-19; Phil 2:10; Acts 21:5; Eph 1:3
v16 — Col 1:11; Phil 4:13; Isa 40:29-31; Isa 41:10; Zech 10:12
v17 — Col 2:7; John 14:23; 1 John 4:16; Gal 2:20; Rom 5:5
v18 — Ps 103:11-12; Job 11:7-9; Eph 1:18-23; John 15:13; Eph 3:19
v19 — Eph 1:23; Col 2:9-10; Col 1:10; 2 Cor 5:14; 1 John 4:9-14
v20 — 2 Cor 9:8; Rom 4:21; Jer 32:27; Jude 1:24; 1 Cor 2:9
v21 — Jude 1:25; Rom 11:36; 2 Pet 3:18; Rev 7:12-17; 1 Pet 5:11

Chapter 4

Paul urges believers to walk worthy of their calling with humility, gentleness, and longsuffering, endeavoring to keep the unity of the Spirit. He teaches that Christ gave apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers to build up the body until all come to the unity of

the faith, and instructs them to put off the old man and put on the new man created in righteousness and true holiness.

- 1

I therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you that ye walk worthy of the vocation wherewith ye are called,

As a prisoner for the Lord, then, I urge You to live a life worthy of the calling You have received.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient endurance with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. It is one of the core virtues Paul lists for the Christian walk. Longsuffering does not just endure — it endures without becoming bitter or harsh.

- 2

With all lowliness and meekness, with longsuffering, forbearing one another in love;

With complete humility and gentleness, with longsuffering, bearing with one another in love.
- 3

Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

Make every effort to keep the unity of the Spirit through the bond of peace.
- 4

There is one body, and one Spirit, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling;

There is one body and one Spirit, just as You were called to one hope when You were called—
- 5

One Lord, one faith, one baptism,

one Lord, one faith, one baptism—
- 6

One God and Father of all, who is above all, and through all, and in you all.

one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all.
- 7

But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ.

But to each one of us grace has been given as Christ apportioned it.
- 8

Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.

Therefore He says: "When He ascended on high, He led captivity captive, and gave gifts to men."
- 9

(Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?

What does "He ascended" mean except that He also descended to the lower, earthly regions?
- 10

He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)

He who descended is the very one who ascended higher than all the heavens, in order to fill the whole universe.

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| 11 <i>And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;</i> | So Christ Himself gave the apostles, the prophets, the evangelists, and the pastors and teachers, |
| 12 <i>For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:</i> | to equip His people for works of service, so that the body of Christ may be built up |
| 13 <i>Till we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:</i> | until we all come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ, |
| 14 <i>That we henceforth be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the sleight of men, and cunning craftiness, whereby they lie in wait to deceive;</i> | Then we will no longer be infants, tossed back and forth by the waves, and blown here and there by every wind of teaching and by the cunning and craftiness of people in their deceitful scheming. |
| 15 <i>But speaking the truth in love, may grow up into him in all things, which is the head, even Christ:</i> | Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will grow to become in every respect the mature body of Him who is the head, that is, Christ. |
| 16 <i>From whom the whole body fitly joined together and compacted by that which every joint supplieth, according to the effectual working in the measure of every part, maketh increase of the body unto the edifying of itself in love.</i> | From Him the whole body, joined and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love as each part does its work. |
| 17 <i>This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind,</i> | So I tell You this, and insist on it in the Lord, that You must no longer live as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their thinking. |

- 18 *Having the understanding darkened, being alienated from the life of God through the ignorance that is in them, because of the blindness of their heart:* They are darkened in their understanding and separated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them due to the hardening of their hearts.
- 19 *Who being past feeling have given themselves over unto lasciviousness, to work all uncleanness with greediness.* Having lost all sensitivity, they have given themselves over to sensuality so as to indulge in every kind of impurity, with a continual lust for more.
- 20 *But ye have not so learned Christ;* That is not the way of life You learned
- 21 *If so be that ye have heard him, and have been taught by him, as the truth is in Jesus:* when You heard about Christ and were taught in Him in accordance with the truth that is in Jesus.
- 22 *That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;* You were taught, with regard to Your former way of life, to put off Your old self, which is being corrupted by its deceitful desires;
- 23 *And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;* to be made new in the attitude of Your minds;
- 24 *And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.* and that You put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.
- 25 *Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.* Therefore, each of You must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to Your neighbor, for we are all members of one body.
- 26 *Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath:* "In Your anger do not sin": Do not let the sun go down while You are still angry,
- 27 *Neither give place to the devil.* and do not give the devil a foothold.

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| <p>28 <i>Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.</i></p> <p>30 <i>And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption.</i></p> <p>31 <i>Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice:</i></p> <p>32 <i>And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.</i></p> | <p>Anyone who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work, doing something useful with their own hands, so that they will have something to share with those in need.</p> <p>Do not let any unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building others up according to their needs, so that it may benefit those who listen.</p> <p>And do not grieve the Holy Ghost of God, with whom You were sealed for the day of redemption.</p> <p>Get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, brawling and slander, along with every form of malice.</p> <p>Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave You.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

v1 — Col 1:10; Phil 1:27; 1 Thess 2:12; 1 Thess 4:1-2; 2 Pet 1:3
v2 — Col 3:12-13; 1 Cor 13:7; 1 Cor 13:4-5; Matt 11:29; Rom 15:1
v11 — Jer 3:15; 1 Cor 12:28-29; Eph 2:20; 2 Tim 4:5; Acts 20:28
v15 — 1 John 3:18; Eph 4:25; Zech 8:16; 1 Pet 1:22; 2 Pet 3:18
v22 — Rom 6:6; Jas 1:21; Heb 12:1; 1 Pet 2:1-2; Heb 3:13
v23 — Rom 12:2; Rom 8:6; Ps 51:10; Col 3:10; 1 Pet 1:13
v24 — Col 3:10-14; 2 Cor 5:17; Eph 2:10; Rom 13:14; Eph 6:11
v26 — Jas 1:19; Ps 4:4; Ps 37:8; Eph 4:31-32; Eccl 7:9
v27 — Jas 4:7; 1 Pet 5:8; Eph 6:16; Eph 6:11; 2 Cor 2:10-11
v29 — Col 4:6; 1 Thess 5:11; Eccl 10:12; Prov 15:7; Col 3:8-9

v30 — 1 Thess 5:19; Isa 63:10; Eph 1:13-14; Gen 6:6; Acts 7:51

v32 — Col 3:12-13; Matt 6:14-15; Mark 11:25; 1 Pet 3:8-9; 2 Cor 2:10

Chapter 5

Paul instructs believers to walk in love as Christ loved us and gave Himself for us, to have no fellowship with the unfruitful works of darkness, and to walk circumspectly, redeeming the time. He teaches on marriage, declaring that husbands are to love their wives as Christ loved the church and gave Himself for it, and that this is a great mystery concerning Christ and the church.

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| 1 | <i>Be ye therefore followers of God, as dear children;</i> | Follow God's example, therefore, as dearly loved children |
| 2 | <i>And walk in love, as Christ also hath loved us, and hath given himself for us an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling savour.</i> | and walk in the way of love, just as Christ loved us and gave Himself up for us as a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God. |
| 3 | <i>But fornication, and all uncleanness, or covetousness, let it not be once named among you, as becometh saints;</i> | But fornication and all uncleanness or covetousness, let it not even be named among You, as is fitting for saints, |
| 4 | <i>Neither filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor jesting, which are not convenient: but rather giving of thanks.</i> | Neither filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor jesting, which are not fitting, but rather the giving of thanks. |
| 5 | <i>For this ye know, that no whoremonger, nor unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, hath any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.</i> | For this You know, that no whoremonger, nor unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, has any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God. |
| 6 | <i>Let no man deceive you with vain words: for because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.</i> | Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of such things God's wrath comes on those who are disobedient. |
| 7 | <i>Be not ye therefore partakers with them.</i> | Therefore do not be partners with them. |

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| 8 <i>For ye were sometimes darkness, but now are ye light in the Lord: walk as children of light:</i> | For You were once darkness, but now You are light in the Lord. Live as children of light |
| 9 <i>(For the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness and righteousness and truth;)</i> | (for the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness, righteousness, and truth) |
| 10 <i>Proving what is acceptable unto the Lord.</i> | and find out what pleases the Lord. |
| 11 <i>And have no fellowship with the unfruitful works of darkness, but rather reprove them.</i> | Have nothing to do with the fruitless deeds of darkness, but rather expose them. |
| 12 <i>For it is a shame even to speak of those things which are done of them in secret.</i> | It is shameful even to mention what the disobedient do in secret. |
| 13 <i>But all things that are reproved are made manifest by the light: for whatsoever doth make manifest is light.</i> | But everything exposed by the light becomes visible — and everything that is illuminated becomes a light. |
| 14 <i>Wherefore he saith, Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light.</i> | This is why it is said: "Wake up, sleeper, rise from the dead, and Christ will shine on You." |
| 15 <i>See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise,</i> | Be very careful, then, how You live — not as unwise but as wise, |
| 16 <i>Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.</i> | making the most of every opportunity, because the days are evil. |
| 17 <i>Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.</i> | Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the Lord's will is. |
| 18 <i>And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;</i> | Do not get drunk on wine, which leads to reckless behavior. Instead, be filled with the Spirit, |

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| 19 <i>Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;</i> | speaking to one another with psalms, hymns, and songs from the Spirit. Sing and make music from Your heart to the Lord, |
| 20 <i>Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ;</i> | always giving thanks to God the Father for everything, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 21 <i>Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.</i> | Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God. |
| 22 <i>Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.</i> | Wives, submit yourselves to Your own husbands as You do to the Lord. |
| 23 <i>For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church: and he is the saviour of the body.</i> | For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church, His body, of which He is the Savior. |
| 24 <i>Therefore as the church is subject unto Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing.</i> | Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything. |
| 25 <i>Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it;</i> | Husbands, love Your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave Himself up for her |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctify** (SANK-tih-fy) — *to set apart as holy; to make clean and consecrated for God. Sanctification is the lifelong process of being made holy. Here Christ sanctifies the church — He sets her apart, cleanses her, and makes her fit to stand before God without spot or blemish.*

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| 26 <i>That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word,</i> | to make her holy, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word, |
| 27 <i>That he might present it to himself a glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish.</i> | and to present her to Himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless. |

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| <p>28 <i>So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies. He that loveth his wife loveth himself.</i></p> <p>29 <i>For no man ever yet hated his own flesh; but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the church:</i></p> <p>30 <i>For we are members of his body, of his flesh, and of his bones.</i></p> <p>31 <i>For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife, and they two shall be one flesh.</i></p> <p>32 <i>This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the church.</i></p> <p>33 <i>Nevertheless let every one of you in particular so love his wife even as himself; and the wife see that she reverence her husband.</i></p> | <p>In the same way, husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself.</p> <p>After all, no one ever hated their own body, but they feed and care for their body, just as Christ does the church—</p> <p>For we are members of His body, of His flesh, and of His bones.</p> <p>"For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh."</p> <p>This is a profound mystery — but I am talking about Christ and the church.</p> <p>However, each one of you also must love his wife as he loves Himself, and the wife must respect her husband.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

righteousness — Being in right standing with God — conforming to His standard; in the NT, the righteousness of Christ credited to believers.

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 John 4:11; 1 Pet 1:15-16; Eph 4:32; Matt 5:48; Luke 6:35-36
v8 — John 8:12; 1 John 1:7; John 12:46; Acts 26:18; Col 1:13
v11 — Rom 13:12; 1 Tim 5:20; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 John 1:10-11; Rom 16:17
v14 — Isa 60:1; Rom 13:11-12; Isa 26:19; 1 Thess 5:6; Isa 52:1
v15 — Col 4:5; Jas 3:13; Phil 1:27; 1 Cor 14:20; Prov 14:8
v16 — Col 4:5; Amos 5:13; John 12:35; Eccl 12:1; Eph 6:13
v17 — Rom 12:2; 1 Thess 5:18; Col 1:9; Eph 5:15; 1 Pet 4:2
v19 — Col 3:16; Ps 95:2; 1 Cor 14:26; Acts 16:25; Ps 147:7
v20 — Col 3:17; 1 Thess 5:18; Heb 13:15; Phil 4:6; Eph 5:4
v22 — Col 3:18-4:1; 1 Pet 3:1-6; Titus 2:5; Gen 3:16; Eph 5:22-6:9
v25 — 1 Pet 3:7; Col 3:19; Eph 5:28; Gen 2:24; Eph 5:33
v26 — Heb 10:22; John 15:3; Ezek 36:25; John 3:5; John 17:17-19

Chapter 6

Paul instructs children to obey their parents, fathers not to provoke their children, servants to obey their masters as unto Christ, and masters to treat their servants justly. He commands believers to put on the whole armour of God — the belt of truth, breastplate of righteousness, shield of faith, helmet of salvation, and sword of the Spirit — to stand against the wiles of the devil.

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| 1 | <i>Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.</i> | Children, obey Your parents in the Lord, for this is right. |
| 2 | <i>Honour thy father and mother; (which is the first commandment with promise;)</i> | "Honor Your father and mother" — which is the first commandment with a promise— |
| 3 | <i>That it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth.</i> | "so that it may go well with You and that You may enjoy long life on the earth." |
| 4 | <i>And, ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.</i> | Fathers, do not exasperate Your children; instead, bring them up in the training and instruction of the Lord. |
| 5 | <i>Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters according to the flesh, with fear and trembling, in singleness of your heart, as unto Christ;</i> | Servants, be obedient to those who are Your masters according to the flesh, with fear and trembling, in sincerity of heart, as to Christ, |
| 6 | <i>Not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but as the servants of Christ, doing the will of God from the heart;</i> | Obey not only when they are watching — as those who want to please men — but as slaves of Christ, doing the will of God from Your heart. |
| 7 | <i>With good will doing service, as to the Lord, and not to men:</i> | Serve wholeheartedly, as if You were serving the Lord, not people, |
| 8 | <i>Knowing that whatsoever good thing any man doeth, the same shall he receive of the Lord, whether he be bond or free.</i> | because You know that the Lord will reward each one for whatever good he does, whether he is slave or free. |

- 9 *And, ye masters, do the same things unto them, forbearing threatening: knowing that your Master also is in heaven; neither is there respect of persons with him.* And, You masters, do the same things to them, giving up threatening, knowing that Your Master also is in heaven, and there is no respect of persons with Him.
- 10 *Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.* Finally, be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might.
- 11 *Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.* Put on the full armor of God, so that you can take your stand against the devil's schemes.
- 12 *For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.* For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms.
- 13 *Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.* Therefore put on the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground. After you have done everything, stand.
- 14 *Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness;* Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness,
- 15 *And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace;* and with your feet fitted with the readiness that comes from the gospel of peace.
- 16 *Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.* In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one.
- 17 *And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:* Take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God.

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| <p>18 <i>Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;</i></p> <p>19 <i>And for me, that utterance may be given unto me, that I may open my mouth boldly, to make known the mystery of the gospel,</i></p> <p>20 <i>For which I am an ambassador in bonds; that therein I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak.</i></p> <p>21 <i>But that ye also may know my affairs, and how I do, Tychicus, a beloved brother and faithful minister in the Lord, shall make known to you all things:</i></p> <p>22 <i>Whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that ye might know our affairs, and that he might comfort your hearts.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Peace be to the brethren, and love with faith, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Grace be with all them that love our Lord Jesus Christ in sincerity. Amen.</i></p> | <p>Pray in the Spirit on all occasions with all kinds of prayers and requests. With this in mind, be alert and always keep on praying for all the Lord's people.</p> <p>Pray also for me, that whenever I speak, words may be given me so that I will fearlessly make known the mystery of the gospel,</p> <p>for which I am an ambassador in chains. Pray that I may declare it fearlessly, as I should.</p> <p>Tychicus, the dear brother and faithful servant in the Lord, will tell You everything so You will know how I am and what I am doing.</p> <p>I am sending Him to You for this very purpose — that You may know how we are and that He may encourage You.</p> <p>Peace to the brothers and sisters, and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.</p> <p>Grace to all who love our Lord Jesus Christ with an undying love.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

breastplate — The high priest's square jeweled pouch worn over the chest — set with twelve gemstones bearing the tribal names; held the Urim and Thummim.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Col 3:20-25; Prov 23:22; Prov 6:20; Prov 1:8; Col 3:16-17
v2 — Ex 20:12; Deut 27:16; Matt 15:4-6; Prov 20:20; Mal 1:6
v4 — Col 3:21; Prov 22:6; Prov 29:15; Prov 19:18; Deut 6:7
v10 — Phil 4:13; Isa 40:31; Josh 1:9; 1 Cor 16:13; 1 Pet 5:10

v11 — 2 Cor 10:4; Rom 13:12; Eph 6:13; 1 Thess 5:8; 1 Pet 5:8

v12 — Col 1:13; 2 Cor 4:4; Eph 2:2; Col 2:15; Acts 26:18

v13 — 2 Cor 10:4; Luke 21:36; Eph 6:11-17; Eph 5:16; Rev 3:10

v14 — Isa 59:17; 1 Thess 5:8; Isa 11:5; Luke 12:35; 2 Cor 6:7

v15 — Isa 52:7; Rom 10:15; 2 Cor 5:18-21; Hab 3:19

v16 — 1 Pet 5:8-9; 1 John 5:4-5; Prov 18:10; Ps 56:3-4; Gen 15:1

v17 — Heb 4:12; Isa 59:17; Rev 19:15; 1 Thess 5:8; Isa 49:2

v18 — 1 Thess 5:17; Col 4:2; Phil 4:6; 1 Tim 2:1; Jude 1:20

Philippians

Author: Paul the apostle, with Timothy named as co-sender (1:1); one of the four Prison Epistles written during Paul's Roman imprisonment.

Date written: c. AD 61–62, from Rome.

Written to: The church at Philippi — the first church Paul planted in Europe (Acts 16), a congregation with whom he had a uniquely warm and trusting relationship.

Setting: Paul is in prison, facing a possible death sentence. The Philippians have sent a financial gift via Epaphroditus, who then became seriously ill. Paul writes to thank them, report on his situation, address minor tensions in the church, and warn against Judaizing teachers.

Where this sits historically: Written from Rome late in Paul's first imprisonment under Nero, after Burrus's death (AD 62) when the climate for Christians in the empire was beginning to harden.

Contemporaries: Timothy and Epaphroditus were at Paul's side, while the prison letters Ephesians, Colossians, and Philemon were composed in this same window.

Big themes:

- Joy — "rejoice" and "joy" appear sixteen times in four chapters; this is the most joyful of Paul's letters, written from a prison cell
- The mind of Christ — the great Christ-hymn of 2:5–11 is the NT's fullest statement of the incarnation; Christ, though equal to God, took the form of a servant and humbled Himself to the cross
- Contentment — Paul has learned "in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content" (4:11); contentment is not a personality trait but a learned discipline
- Partnership in the gospel — the Philippians are Paul's ministry partners; he uses the language of business partnership (*koinonia*) to describe their shared investment in the gospel
- Pressing toward the mark — the Christian life is an active, forward-straining pursuit of knowing Christ and attaining the resurrection

Key passages: Phil 1:21; 2:5–8; 3:10; 4:7; 4:11–13

How it fits: Philippians is the most personal of Paul's congregational letters. Written in chains, it is the NT's proof that joy is not circumstantial. Chapter 2's Christ-hymn is one of the most studied Christological passages in the NT, and 4:6–7 on prayer and peace has comforted the church in every generation since.

Chapter 1

Paul thanks God for the Philippians' partnership in the gospel and prays that their love would abound more and more in knowledge. He declares that his imprisonment has served to advance the gospel, and that for him to live is Christ and to die is gain, though he remains confident that he will stay and continue with them for their joy and progress in the faith.

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| 1 <i>Paul and Timotheus, the servants of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus which are at Philippi, with the bishops and deacons:</i> | Paul and Timothy, servants of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus Who are at Philippi, with the bishops and deacons: |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift you could never earn or deserve. Paul writes Philippians from prison, yet the letter is full of joy. That joy is rooted in grace — the certainty that God's favor rests on His people not because of what they do but because of what Christ has done.*

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| 2 <i>Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | Grace and peace to You from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 3 <i>I thank my God upon every remembrance of you,</i> | I thank my God every time I remember You. |
| 4 <i>Always in every prayer of mine for you all making request with joy,</i> | In all my prayers for all of You, I always pray with joy |
| 5 <i>For your fellowship in the gospel from the first day until now;</i> | because of Your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now, |
| 6 <i>Being confident of this very thing, that he which hath begun a good work in you will perform it until the day of Jesus Christ:</i> | being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus. |
| 7 <i>Even as it is meet for me to think this of you all, because I have you in my heart; inasmuch as both in my bonds, and in the defence and confirmation of the gospel, ye all are partakers of my grace.</i> | It is right for me to feel this way about all of You, since I have You in my heart. Whether I am in chains or defending and confirming the gospel, all of You share in God's grace with me. |
| 8 <i>For God is my record, how greatly I long after you all in the bowels of Jesus Christ.</i> | For God is my witness, how greatly I long for You all in the bowels of Jesus Christ. |

- 9 *And this I pray, that your love may abound yet more and more in knowledge and in all judgment;* And this is my prayer: that Your love may abound more and more in knowledge and depth of insight,
- 10 *That ye may approve things that are excellent; that ye may be sincere and without offence till the day of Christ;* so that You may be able to discern what is best and may be pure and blameless until the day of Christ,
- 11 *Being filled with the fruits of righteousness, which are by Jesus Christ, unto the glory and praise of God.* filled with the fruit of righteousness that comes through Jesus Christ — to the glory and praise of God.
- 12 *But I would ye should understand, brethren, that the things which happened unto me have fallen out rather unto the furtherance of the gospel;* Now I want You to know, brothers and sisters, that what has happened to me has actually served to advance the gospel.
- 13 *So that my bonds in Christ are manifest in all the palace, and in all other places;* As a result, it has become clear throughout the whole palace guard and to everyone else that I am in chains for Christ.
- 14 *And many of the brethren in the Lord, waxing confident by my bonds, are much more bold to speak the word without fear.* And because of my chains, most of the brothers and sisters have become confident in the Lord and dare all the more to proclaim the gospel without fear.
- 15 *Some indeed preach Christ even of envy and strife; and some also of good will:* It is true that some preach Christ out of envy and rivalry, but others out of goodwill.
- 16 *The one preach Christ of contention, not sincerely, supposing to add affliction to my bonds:* The latter do so out of love, knowing that I am put here for the defense of the gospel.
- 17 *But the other of love, knowing that I am set for the defence of the gospel.* The former preach Christ out of selfish ambition, not sincerely, supposing that they can stir up trouble for me while I am in chains.

- 18 *What then? notwithstanding, every way, whether in pretence, or in truth, Christ is preached; and I therein do rejoice, yea, and will rejoice.* But what does it matter? The important thing is that in every way, whether from false motives or true, Christ is preached. And because of this I rejoice. Yes, and I will continue to rejoice,
- 19 *For I know that this shall turn to my salvation through your prayer, and the supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ,* for I know that through Your prayers and the help of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, what has happened to me will turn out for my deliverance.
- 20 *According to my earnest expectation and my hope, that in nothing I shall be ashamed, but that with all boldness, as always, so now also Christ shall be magnified in my body, whether it be by life, or by death.* I eagerly expect and hope that I will in no way be ashamed, but will have sufficient courage so that now as always Christ will be exalted in my body, whether by life or by death.
- 21 *For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.* For to me, to live is Christ and to die is gain.
- 22 *But if I live in the flesh, this is the fruit of my labour: yet what I shall choose I wot not.* If I am to go on living in the body, this will mean fruitful labor for me. Yet what shall I choose? I do not know!
- 23 *For I am in a strait betwixt two, having a desire to depart, and to be with Christ; which is far better:* I am torn between the two: I desire to depart and be with Christ, which is better by far;
- 24 *Nevertheless to abide in the flesh is more needful for you.* but it is more necessary for You that I remain in the body.
- 25 *And having this confidence, I know that I shall abide and continue with you all for your furtherance and joy of faith;* Convinced of this, I know that I will remain and continue with all of You for Your progress and joy in the faith,
- 26 *That your rejoicing may be more abundant in Jesus Christ for me by my coming to you again.* so that through my being with You again Your joy in Christ Jesus will overflow on account of me.

- 27 *Only let your conversation be as it becometh the gospel of Christ: that whether I come and see you, or else be absent, I may hear of your affairs, that ye stand fast in one spirit, with one mind striving together for the faith of the gospel;* Whatever happens, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see You or only hear about You in my absence, I will know that You stand firm in the one Spirit, striving together as one for the faith of the gospel
- 28 *And in nothing terrified by your adversaries: which is to them an evident token of perdition, but to you of salvation, and that of God.* without being frightened in any way by those who oppose You. This is a sign to them that they will be destroyed, but that You will be saved — and that by God.
- 29 *For unto you it is given in the behalf of Christ, not only to believe on him, but also to suffer for his sake;* For it has been granted to You on behalf of Christ not only to believe in Him, but also to suffer for Him,
- 30 *Having the same conflict which ye saw in me, and now hear to be in me.* since You are going through the same struggle You saw I had and now hear that I still have.

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

wot — Know or knew — an archaic form of 'know'; 'I wot not' means 'I do not know.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Cor 1:1; Acts 16:12-15; Rom 1:1; Col 1:1-2; Titus 1:1
v3 — 1 Cor 1:4; 1 Thess 1:2-3; Phlm 1:4-5; 2 Tim 1:3; Eph 1:15-16
v6 — 1 Thess 5:23-24; Phil 2:13; Eph 4:12; Heb 13:20-21; Ps 138:8
v9 — 1 Thess 3:12; Col 1:9; 2 Pet 1:5-6; Phlm 1:6; Col 3:10
v10 — Rom 12:2; 1 Thess 3:13; 1 Thess 5:23; Rom 2:18; Eph 5:10
v11 — Heb 12:11; John 15:8; Col 1:10; John 15:4-5; Gal 5:22-23
v12 — 2 Tim 2:9; Rom 8:28; Acts 11:19-21; Rom 8:37; Acts 8:4
v18 — Luke 9:50; Mark 9:38-40; 1 Cor 15:11; Phil 1:14-17
v21 — Gal 2:20; 2 Cor 5:8; 2 Cor 5:1; Phil 1:23; 2 Cor 5:6
v27 — Eph 4:1; 1 Cor 16:13-14; 2 Pet 3:14; 1 Cor 1:10; Phil 2:1-2
v28 — 2 Tim 1:7-8; 2 Thess 1:5-6; Matt 10:28; 2 Tim 2:11-12; Isa 51:7
v29 — Jas 1:2; 1 Pet 4:13; Acts 5:41; Rom 5:3; Acts 14:22

Chapter 2

Paul urges the Philippians to be like-minded, esteeming others better than themselves, and points to Christ, who though He was in the form of God made Himself of no reputation, took the form of a servant, humbled Himself, and became obedient unto death — even the death of the cross. He instructs them to work out their own salvation with fear and trembling, for it is God who works in them both to will and to do of His good pleasure.

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| 1 | <i>If there be therefore any consolation in Christ, if any comfort of love, if any fellowship of the Spirit, if any bowels and mercies,</i> | Therefore if You have any encouragement from being united with Christ, if any comfort from His love, if any common sharing in the Spirit, if any tenderness and compassion, |
| 2 | <i>Fulfil ye my joy, that ye be likeminded, having the same love, being of one accord, of one mind.</i> | then make my joy complete by being like-minded, having the same love, being one in spirit and of one mind. |
| 3 | <i>Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves.</i> | Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit. Rather, in humility value others above yourselves, |
| 4 | <i>Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.</i> | not looking to Your own interests but each of You to the interests of the others. |
| 5 | <i>Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus:</i> | Let this mind be in You, which was also in Christ Jesus: |
| 6 | <i>Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God:</i> | Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God, |
| 7 | <i>But made himself of no reputation, and took upon him the form of a servant, and was made in the likeness of men:</i> | but made Himself of no reputation, and took upon Him the form of a servant, and was made in the likeness of men. |
| 8 | <i>And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself, and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross.</i> | And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself and became obedient to death — even the death of the cross. |

- 9 *Wherefore God also hath highly exalted him, and given him a name which is above every name:* Therefore God has also highly exalted Him and given Him a name which is above every name,
- 10 *That at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth;* that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth,
- 11 *And that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.* and that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.
- 12 *Wherefore, my beloved, as ye have always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.* Therefore, my dear friends, as You have always obeyed — not only in my presence but now much more in my absence — continue to work out Your salvation with fear and trembling,
- 13 *For it is God which worketh in you both to will and to do of his good pleasure.* for it is God Who works in You to will and to act in order to fulfill His good purpose.
- 14 *Do all things without murmurings and disputings:* Do everything without grumbling or arguing,
- 15 *That ye may be blameless and harmless, the sons of God, without rebuke, in the midst of a crooked and perverse nation, among whom ye shine as lights in the world;* so that You may become blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a warped and crooked generation. Then You will shine among them like stars in the sky
- 16 *Holding forth the word of life; that I may rejoice in the day of Christ, that I have not run in vain, neither laboured in vain.* as You hold firmly to the word of life. This will enable me to boast on the day of Christ that I did not run or labor in vain.
- 17 *Yea, and if I be offered upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I joy, and rejoice with you all.* But even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service coming from Your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of You.

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| 18 <i>For the same cause also do ye joy, and rejoice with me.</i> | So You too should be glad and rejoice with me. |
| 19 <i>But I trust in the Lord Jesus to send Timotheus shortly unto you, that I also may be of good comfort, when I know your state.</i> | I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered when I receive news about You. |
| 20 <i>For I have no man likeminded, who will naturally care for your state.</i> | I have no one else like him who will genuinely care for your welfare. |
| 21 <i>For all seek their own, not the things which are Jesus Christ's.</i> | For everyone looks out for their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ. |
| 22 <i>But ye know the proof of him, that, as a son with the father, he hath served with me in the gospel.</i> | But you know that Timothy has proved himself, because as a son with his father he has served with me in the work of the gospel. |
| 23 <i>Him therefore I hope to send presently, so soon as I shall see how it will go with me.</i> | I hope, therefore, to send him as soon as I see how things go with me. |
| 24 <i>But I trust in the Lord that I also myself shall come shortly.</i> | And I am confident in the Lord that I myself will come soon. |
| 25 <i>Yet I supposed it necessary to send to you Epaphroditus, my brother, and companion in labour, and fellowsoldier, but your messenger, and he that ministered to my wants.</i> | But I think it is necessary to send back to you Epaphroditus, my brother, co-worker, and fellow soldier, who is also your messenger, whom you sent to take care of my needs. |
| 26 <i>For he longed after you all, and was full of heaviness, because that ye had heard that he had been sick.</i> | For he longs for all of you and is distressed because you heard he was ill. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. Here Paul uses it in a broader sense: God's compassion shown to Epaphroditus in sparing his life. Mercy is not only judicial — it also describes every moment God tenderly holds back suffering from those He loves.

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| <p>27 <i>For indeed he was sick nigh unto death: but God had mercy on him; and not on him only, but on me also, lest I should have sorrow upon sorrow.</i></p> <p>28 <i>I sent him therefore the more carefully, that, when ye see him again, ye may rejoice, and that I may be the less sorrowful.</i></p> <p>29 <i>Receive him therefore in the Lord with all gladness; and hold such in reputation:</i></p> <p>30 <i>Because for the work of Christ he was nigh unto death, not regarding his life, to supply your lack of service toward me.</i></p> | <p>Indeed he was ill, and almost died. But God had mercy on him — and not on Him only but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow.</p> <p>Therefore I am all the more eager to send him, so that when you see him again you may be glad and I may have less anxiety.</p> <p>So then, welcome him in the Lord with great joy and honor people like Him,</p> <p>because He almost died for the work of Christ. He risked His life to make up for the help You yourselves could not give me.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

faith — Trust and reliance on God — not mere intellectual belief, but active dependence on His word and promises.

mercy — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment — God withholding the wrath we have earned.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Rom 12:16; 1 Pet 3:8-9; 1 Cor 1:10; 2 Cor 13:11; 3 John 1:4
- v3 — Rom 12:10; Gal 5:26; Eph 5:21; Eph 4:2; 1 Pet 5:5
- v4 — 1 Cor 10:24; Rom 15:1; Jas 2:8; 1 Cor 13:4-5; 1 Cor 10:32-33
- v5 — 1 John 2:6; Matt 11:29; 1 Pet 2:21; 1 Pet 4:1; 1 Cor 10:33-11:1
- v6 — John 5:18; 2 Cor 4:4; Heb 1:3; John 17:5; Col 1:15-16
- v7 — 2 Cor 8:9; Matt 20:28; John 1:14; Rom 8:3; Isa 53:2-3
- v8 — John 10:18; Heb 12:2; Rom 5:19; 1 Pet 2:24; 1 Pet 3:18
- v9 — Rev 19:16; Matt 28:18; 1 Pet 3:22; Isa 52:13; Heb 2:9
- v10 — Isa 45:23-25; Matt 28:18; Rev 5:13-14; Heb 1:6; Rom 14:10-11
- v12 — 2 Pet 1:5-10; Luke 13:23-24; 1 Cor 15:58; Heb 4:11; 1 Pet 2:11
- v13 — Heb 13:21; 2 Cor 3:5; 2 Tim 1:9; Rom 9:16; 1 Cor 15:10
- v14 — 1 Pet 4:9; 1 Cor 10:10; Eph 4:31-32; Jas 5:9; Phil 2:3

Chapter 3

Paul warns against those who put confidence in the flesh, listing his own impressive credentials as a Hebrew of the Hebrews and a Pharisee, but counting all things loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus his Lord. He presses toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus, and declares that our citizenship is in heaven.

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| <p>1 <i>Finally, my brethren, rejoice in the Lord. To write the same things to you, to me indeed is not grievous, but for you it is safe.</i></p> | <p>Further, my brothers and sisters, rejoice in the Lord! It is no trouble for me to write the same things to You again, and it is a safeguard for You.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Beware of dogs, beware of evil workers, beware of the concision.</i></p> | <p>Beware of dogs, beware of evil workers, beware of the concision.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For we are the circumcision, which worship God in the spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh.</i></p> | <p>For it is we who are the circumcision — we who serve God by His Spirit, who boast in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh—</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Though I might also have confidence in the flesh. If any other man thinketh that he hath whereof he might trust in the flesh, I more:</i></p> | <p>though I myself have reasons for such confidence. If someone else thinks they have reasons to put confidence in the flesh, I have more:</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Circumcised the eighth day, of the stock of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, an Hebrew of the Hebrews; as touching the law, a Pharisee;</i></p> | <p>circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Hebrew of Hebrews; in regard to the law, a Pharisee;</p> |
| <p>6 <i>Concerning zeal, persecuting the church; touching the righteousness which is in the law, blameless.</i></p> | <p>as for zeal, persecuting the church; as for righteousness based on the law, faultless.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>But what things were gain to me, those I counted loss for Christ.</i></p> | <p>But whatever was to my profit I now consider loss for the sake of Christ.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Yea doubtless, and I count all things but loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord: for whom I have suffered the loss of all things, and do count them but dung, that I may win Christ,</i></p> | <p>Yes, no doubt, and I count all things as loss for the excellence of the knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord, for whom I have suffered the loss of all things, and count them as dung, that I may win Christ</p> |

- 9 *And be found in him, not having mine own righteousness, which is of the law, but that which is through the faith of Christ, the righteousness which is of God by faith:* and be found in Him, not having a righteousness of my own that comes from the law, but that which is through faith in Christ — the righteousness that comes from God on the basis of faith.
- 10 *That I may know him, and the power of his resurrection, and the fellowship of his sufferings, being made conformable unto his death;* I want to know Christ — yes, to know the power of His resurrection and participation in His sufferings, becoming like Him in His death,
- 11 *If by any means I might attain unto the resurrection of the dead.* and so, somehow, attaining to the resurrection from the dead.
- 12 *Not as though I had already attained, either were already perfect: but I follow after, if that I may apprehend that for which also I am apprehended of Christ Jesus.* Not that I have already obtained all this or have already arrived at my goal, but I press on to take hold of that for which Christ Jesus took hold of me.
- 13 *Brethren, I count not myself to have apprehended: but this one thing I do, forgetting those things which are behind, and reaching forth unto those things which are before,* Brothers and sisters, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead,
- 14 *I press toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.* I press on toward the goal to win the prize for which God has called me heavenward in Christ Jesus.
- 15 *Let us therefore, as many as be perfect, be thus minded: and if in any thing ye be otherwise minded, God shall reveal even this unto you.* All of us, then, who are mature should take such a view of things. And if on some point You think differently, that too God will make clear to You.
- 16 *Nevertheless, whereto we have already attained, let us walk by the same rule, let us mind the same thing.* Only let us live up to what we have already attained.

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| <p>17 <i>Brethren, be followers together of me, and mark them which walk so as ye have us for an ensample.</i></p> <p>18 <i>(For many walk, of whom I have told you often, and now tell you even weeping, that they are the enemies of the cross of Christ:</i></p> <p>19 <i>Whose end is destruction, whose God is their belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who mind earthly things.)</i></p> <p>20 <i>For our conversation is in heaven; from whence also we look for the Saviour, the Lord Jesus Christ:</i></p> <p>21 <i>Who shall change our vile body, that it may be fashioned like unto his glorious body, according to the working whereby he is able even to subdue all things unto himself.</i></p> | <p>Join together in following my example, brothers and sisters, and just as You have us as a model, keep Your eyes on those who live as we do.</p> <p>For, as I have often told You before and now tell You again even with tears, many live as enemies of the cross of Christ.</p> <p>Their end is destruction, their god is their stomach, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things.</p> <p>For our conversation is in heaven, from where we also look for the Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ,</p> <p>who, by the power that enables Him to bring everything under His control, will transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like His glorious body.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Cross-References:

v2 — 2 Cor 11:13; Titus 1:16; Rev 22:15; Isa 56:10-11; 2 Tim 3:1-6
v3 — Col 2:11; Deut 30:6; Rom 7:6; Gal 6:13-15; Rom 8:15
v7 — Luke 14:33; Matt 16:26; Matt 13:44-46; Prov 13:8; Luke 14:26
v8 — Jer 9:23-24; Rom 8:18; Acts 20:24; Phil 3:7; John 17:3
v9 — 2 Cor 5:21; 1 Cor 1:30; Gal 2:16; Rom 4:13-15; Rom 4:5-6
v10 — Gal 2:20; 2 Tim 2:11-12; 1 Pet 4:1-2; Rom 8:17; Rom 6:3-11
v12 — 1 Tim 6:11-12; 2 Pet 1:5-8; Ps 138:8; Hos 6:3; 1 Pet 3:11-13
v13 — Luke 9:62; Heb 12:1-2; Phil 3:12; 1 Cor 9:24-27; Ps 27:4
v14 — 1 Cor 9:24; 1 Pet 5:10; Rev 3:21; 2 Tim 4:7-8; Rom 8:28-30
v19 — Rom 16:18; Rom 8:5-7; 2 Pet 2:3; Col 3:2; Jude 1:12-13
v20 — Eph 2:19; Col 3:1-3; 2 Cor 4:18-5:1; Heb 12:22; 1 Pet 1:3-4

v21 — 1 John 3:2; Col 3:4; 1 Cor 15:42-56; Rom 8:29; John 11:24-26

Chapter 4

Paul urges the Philippians to rejoice in the Lord always and to be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving to let their requests be made known to God. He teaches them to think on things that are true, honest, just, pure, and lovely, and declares that he can do all things through Christ who strengthens him.

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| 1 | <i>Therefore, my brethren dearly beloved and longed for, my joy and crown, so stand fast in the Lord, my dearly beloved.</i> | Therefore, my brothers and sisters, You whom I love and long for, my joy and crown, stand firm in the Lord in this way, dear friends! |
| 2 | <i>I beseech Euodias, and beseech Syntyche, that they be of the same mind in the Lord.</i> | I plead with Euodia and I plead with Syntyche to be of the same mind in the Lord. |
| 3 | <i>And I intreat thee also, true yokefellow, help those women which laboured with me in the gospel, with Clement also, and with other my fellowlabourers, whose names are in the book of life.</i> | Yes, and I ask You, my true companion, help these women since they have contended at my side in the cause of the gospel, along with Clement and the rest of my co-workers, whose names are in the book of life. |
| 4 | <i>Rejoice in the Lord alway: and again I say, Rejoice.</i> | Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! |
| 5 | <i>Let your moderation be known unto all men. The Lord is at hand.</i> | Let Your gentleness be evident to all. The Lord is near. |
| 6 | <i>Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.</i> | Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present Your requests to God. |
| 7 | <i>And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.</i> | And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard Your hearts and Your minds in Christ Jesus. |

- 8 *Finally, brethren, whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things.* Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable — if anything is excellent or praiseworthy — think about such things.
- 9 *Those things, which ye have both learned, and received, and heard, and seen in me, do: and the God of peace shall be with you.* Whatever You have learned or received or heard from me, or seen in me — put it into practice. And the God of peace will be with You.
- 10 *But I rejoiced in the Lord greatly, that now at the last your care of me hath flourished again; wherein ye were also careful, but ye lacked opportunity.* I rejoiced greatly in the Lord that at last You renewed Your concern for me. Indeed, You were concerned, but You had no opportunity to show it.
- 11 *Not that I speak in respect of want: for I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content.* I am not saying this because I am in need, for I have learned to be content whatever the circumstances.
- 12 *I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound: every where and in all things I am instructed both to be full and to be hungry, both to abound and to suffer need.* I know what it is to be in need, and I know what it is to have plenty. I have learned the secret of being content in any and every situation, whether well fed or hungry, whether living in plenty or in want.
- 13 *I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.* I can do all things through Christ Who gives me strength.
- 14 *Notwithstanding ye have well done, that ye did communicate with my affliction.* Yet it was good of You to share in my trouble.

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| <p>15 <i>Now ye Philippians know also, that in the beginning of the gospel, when I departed from Macedonia, no church communicated with me as concerning giving and receiving, but ye only.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For even in Thessalonica ye sent once and again unto my necessity.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Not because I desire a gift: but I desire fruit that may abound to your account.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But I have all, and abound: I am full, having received of Epaphroditus the things which were sent from you, an odour of a sweet smell, a sacrifice acceptable, wellpleasing to God.</i></p> <p>19 <i>But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Now unto God and our Father be glory for ever and ever. Amen.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Salute every saint in Christ Jesus. The brethren which are with me greet you.</i></p> <p>22 <i>All the saints salute you, chiefly they that are of Caesar's household.</i></p> <p>23 <i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.</i></p> | <p>Moreover, as You Philippians know, in the early days of Your acquaintance with the gospel, when I set out from Macedonia, not one church shared with me in the matter of giving and receiving, except You only.</p> <p>For even when I was in Thessalonica, You sent me aid more than once when I was in need.</p> <p>Not that I desire Your gifts; what I desire is that more be credited to Your account.</p> <p>I have received full payment and have more than enough. I am amply supplied, now that I have received from Epaphroditus the gifts You sent. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, pleasing to God.</p> <p>And my God will meet all Your needs according to the riches of His glory in Christ Jesus.</p> <p>To our God and Father be glory forever and ever. Amen.</p> <p>Greet all God's people in Christ Jesus. The brothers and sisters who are with me send greetings.</p> <p>All God's people here send You greetings, especially those who belong to Caesar's household.</p> <p>The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with Your spirit. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Phil 1:27; 1 Cor 16:13; Ps 27:14; Phil 2:16; 1 Cor 15:58
- v2** — Heb 12:14; 1 Cor 1:10; Mark 9:50; 1 Pet 3:8-11; Phil 2:2-3
- v4** — 1 Thess 5:16-18; Rom 12:12; Jas 1:2-4; Phil 3:1; Matt 5:12
- v5** — Jas 5:8-9; Matt 6:25; Titus 3:2; Heb 10:37; 1 Pet 4:7
- v6** — Prov 3:5-6; 1 Pet 5:7; Matt 6:25-33; Ps 55:22; 1 Thess 5:17-18
- v7** — John 14:27; Isa 26:3; 2 Thess 3:16; Col 3:15; Ps 29:11
- v8** — Jas 3:17; Titus 2:7; Rom 12:9-21; 2 Cor 8:21; Gal 5:22
- v9** — Jas 1:22; Phil 3:17; 1 Thess 4:1-8; 2 Pet 1:10; John 13:17
- v11** — 1 Tim 6:6-9; Heb 13:5-6; Matt 6:31-34; 2 Cor 9:8; Phil 3:8
- v12** — Matt 11:29; 2 Cor 12:7-10; 2 Cor 11:27; 2 Cor 11:9; 2 Cor 6:4-10
- v13** — Isa 41:10; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Col 1:11; Eph 6:10; Isa 40:29-31
- v19** — 2 Cor 9:8-11; Ps 84:11; 1 Pet 5:10; Ps 23:1-5; 1 Tim 6:17

Colossians

Author: Paul the apostle, with Timothy named as co-sender (1:1); one of the four Prison Epistles.

Date written: c. AD 60–62, from Rome, delivered by Tychicus along with Ephesians and the letter to Philemon.

Written to: The church at Colossae — a congregation in the Lycus Valley of Asia Minor that Paul had not personally founded; it was planted by Epaphras (1:7).

Setting: A "Colossian heresy" has emerged — a syncretistic teaching combining Jewish elements (circumcision, food laws, calendar observance) with angel worship and mystical "philosophy." It amounts to adding requirements to Christ for full spiritual experience. Paul's response is to lift Christ higher.

Where this sits historically: Written during Paul's first Roman imprisonment under Nero, just years after a devastating earthquake (AD 60) had struck the Lycus Valley cities of Colossae, Laodicea, and Hierapolis.

Contemporaries: Epaphras, Tychicus, Onesimus, Aristarchus, Luke, and Mark were all with Paul as he wrote, and Ephesians and Philemon were carried alongside this letter.

Big themes:

- The supremacy of Christ — the great Christ-hymn of 1:15–20 is the most exalted statement of Christ's pre-eminence in the NT; He is before all things, the firstborn of all creation, and in Him all things hold together
- Complete in Christ — believers are "complete in him" (2:10); nothing needs to be added to Christ for full standing before God
- The new life in Christ — chapters 3–4 move from doctrine to practice; the old self is put off, the new self put on, and all of life is done "in the name of the Lord Jesus"
- False philosophy — "Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit" (2:8); the Colossian error is the template for every subsequent attempt to supplement the gospel
- The mystery revealed — the gospel hidden for ages is now made known: "Christ in you, the hope of glory" (1:27)

Key passages: Col 1:15–18; 1:27; 2:8–10; 3:1–3; 3:17

How it fits: Colossians is the companion letter to Ephesians — both written at the same time, delivered by the same messenger, addressing similar themes. Where Ephesians focuses on the church as Christ's body, Colossians focuses on Christ as the head of that body. The TR reading of 1:14 — "redemption through his blood" — grounds the letter's soteriology in the atonement.

Chapter 1

Paul gives thanks for the Colossians' faith and prays that they would be filled with the knowledge of God's will. He declares the supremacy of Christ — the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of every creature, by whom all things were created — and that in Him all fulness dwells, and through His blood He has reconciled all things to Himself.

- 1

Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, and Timotheus our brother,
- Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and Timothy our brother,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

- 2

To the saints and faithful brethren in Christ which are at Colosse: Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
- To God's holy people in Colosse, the faithful brothers and sisters in Christ: grace and peace to You from God our Father.
- 3

We give thanks to God and the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, praying always for you,
- We always thank God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, when we pray for You,
- 4

Since we heard of your faith in Christ Jesus, and of the love which ye have to all the saints,
- because we have heard of Your faith in Christ Jesus and of the love You have for all God's people—
- 5

For the hope which is laid up for you in heaven, whereof ye heard before in the word of the truth of the gospel;
- the hope stored up for You in heaven and about which You have already heard in the true message of the gospel
- 6

Which is come unto you, as it is in all the world; and bringeth forth fruit, as it doth also in you, since the day ye heard of it, and knew the grace of God in truth:
- that has come to You. In the same way, the gospel is bearing fruit and growing throughout the whole world — just as it has been doing among You since the day You heard it and truly understood God's grace.
- 7

As ye also learned of Epaphras our dear fellowservant, who is for you a faithful minister of Christ;
- You learned it from Epaphras, our dear fellow servant, who is a faithful minister of Christ on our behalf,
- 8

Who also declared unto us your love in the Spirit.
- and who also told us of Your love in the Spirit.

- 9 *For this cause we also, since the day we heard it, do not cease to pray for you, and to desire that ye might be filled with the knowledge of his will in all wisdom and spiritual understanding;* For this reason, since the day we heard about You, we have not stopped praying for You. We continually ask God to fill You with the knowledge of His will through all the wisdom and understanding that the Spirit gives,
- 10 *That ye might walk worthy of the Lord unto all pleasing, being fruitful in every good work, and increasing in the knowledge of God;* so that You may live a life worthy of the Lord and please Him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — *patient endurance with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. Longsuffering is not weakness — it is strength held back. God is longsuffering toward sinners, bearing with them rather than judging immediately.*

- 11 *Strengthened with all might, according to his glorious power, unto all patience and longsuffering with joyfulness;* being strengthened with all power according to His glorious might so that You may have great endurance and longsuffering, and giving joyful thanks to the Father,
- 12 *Giving thanks unto the Father, which hath made us meet to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light:* who has qualified You to share in the inheritance of His holy people in the kingdom of light.
- 13 *Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son:* For He has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of the Son He loves,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (reh-DEMP-shun) — *to buy back; to set free by paying a price. In the ancient world, a slave could be redeemed — bought out of bondage. Christ redeemed us from sin's slavery by paying with His own blood. We were bought back at infinite cost.*

- 14 *In whom we have redemption through his blood, even the forgiveness of sins:* in whom we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins.
- 15 *Who is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of every creature:* He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of every creature.

- 16 *For by him were all things created, that are in heaven, and that are in earth, visible and invisible, whether they be thrones, or dominions, or principalities, or powers: all things were created by him, and for him:* For in Him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or powers or rulers or authorities — all things have been created through Him and for Him.
- 17 *And he is before all things, and by him all things consist.* He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together.
- 18 *And he is the head of the body, the church: who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead; that in all things he might have the preeminence.* And He is the head of the body, the church. He is the beginning and the firstborn from among the dead, so that in everything He might have the supremacy.
- 19 *For it pleased the Father that in him should all fulness dwell;* For God was pleased to have all His fullness dwell in Him,
- 20 *And, having made peace through the blood of his cross, by him to reconcile all things unto himself; by him, I say, whether they be things in earth, or things in heaven.* and through Him to reconcile to Himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven, by making peace through His blood, shed on the cross.
- 21 *And you, that were sometime alienated and enemies in your mind by wicked works, yet now hath he reconciled* Once You were alienated from God and were enemies in Your minds because of Your evil behavior. But now He has reconciled You
- 22 *In the body of his flesh through death, to present you holy and unblameable and unreprouvable in his sight:* by Christ's physical body through death to present You holy in His sight, without blemish and free from accusation—
- 23 *If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled, and be not moved away from the hope of the gospel, which ye have heard, and which was preached to every creature which is under heaven; whereof I Paul am made a minister;* if you continue in your faith, established and firm, and do not move from the hope held out in the gospel. This is the gospel you heard and that has been proclaimed to every creature under heaven, and of which I, Paul, have become a servant.

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| <p>24 <i>Who now rejoice in my sufferings for you, and fill up that which is behind of the afflictions of Christ in my flesh for his body's sake, which is the church:</i></p> <p>25 <i>Whereof I am made a minister, according to the dispensation of God which is given to me for you, to fulfil the word of God;</i></p> <p>26 <i>Even the mystery which hath been hid from ages and from generations, but now is made manifest to his saints:</i></p> <p>27 <i>To whom God would make known what is the riches of the glory of this mystery among the Gentiles; which is Christ in you, the hope of glory:</i></p> <p>28 <i>Whom we preach, warning every man, and teaching every man in all wisdom; that we may present every man perfect in Christ Jesus:</i></p> <p>29 <i>Whereunto I also labour, striving according to his working, which worketh in me mightily.</i></p> | <p>Now I rejoice in what I am suffering for You, and I fill up in my flesh what is still lacking in regard to Christ's afflictions, for the sake of His body, which is the church.</p> <p>I have become its servant by the commission God gave me to present to You the word of God in its fullness—</p> <p>the mystery that has been kept hidden for ages and generations, but is now disclosed to the Lord's people.</p> <p>To them God has chosen to make known among the Gentiles the glorious riches of this mystery, which is Christ in You, the hope of glory.</p> <p>He is the one we proclaim, admonishing and teaching everyone with all wisdom, so that we may present everyone fully mature in Christ.</p> <p>To this end I strenuously contend with all the energy Christ so powerfully works in me.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

v9 — Jas 3:17; Phil 1:9-11; Jas 1:5; Eph 1:15-20; 1 Thess 5:17

v10 — Eph 4:1; Heb 13:21; 2 Pet 1:2-3; John 15:16; 1 John 3:22

v11 — Eph 3:16; Phil 4:13; Eph 4:2; Eph 6:10; Rom 5:3-5
v13 — Eph 5:8; Acts 26:18; 1 Pet 2:9; Titus 3:3-6; 1 Thess 2:12
v14 — Eph 1:7; Rom 3:24-25; 1 Pet 1:19-20; Heb 9:12; Heb 9:22
v15 — Heb 1:3; John 14:9; John 1:1; 2 Cor 4:4; John 1:18
v16 — Rom 11:36; John 1:3; 1 Cor 8:6; Heb 2:10; 1 Chr 29:11
v17 — Heb 1:3; 1 Cor 8:6; John 17:5; Acts 17:28; John 8:58
v18 — Eph 1:22-23; Rev 1:5; Eph 4:15-16; 1 Cor 15:20-23; Acts 26:23
v20 — 2 Cor 5:18-21; Eph 1:10; 1 John 4:9-10; Col 1:21-22; Eph 2:13-17
v23 — Heb 3:14; Heb 3:6; Matt 24:13-14; Gal 6:9; Heb 10:38
v27 — John 14:20; Rom 8:10; Eph 3:16-17; 1 John 4:4; Gal 2:20

Chapter 2

Paul warns against being deceived by philosophy and vain deceit, according to the tradition of men, and declares that in Christ dwells all the fulness of the godhead bodily. He teaches that believers are complete in Christ, that the handwriting of ordinances against them was nailed to the cross, and that no man should judge them in matters of food, drink, holy days, or sabbaths.

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| 1 | <i>For I would that ye knew what great conflict I have for you, and for them at Laodicea, and for as many as have not seen my face in the flesh;</i> | I want You to know how hard I am contending for You and for those at Laodicea, and for all who have not met me personally. |
| 2 | <i>That their hearts might be comforted, being knit together in love, and unto all riches of the full assurance of understanding, to the acknowledgement of the mystery of God, and of the Father, and of Christ;</i> | My goal is that they may be encouraged in heart and united in love, so that they may have the full riches of complete understanding, in order that they may know the mystery of God, namely, Christ, |
| 3 | <i>In whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.</i> | in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. |
| 4 | <i>And this I say, lest any man should beguile you with enticing words.</i> | I tell You this so that no one may deceive you by fine-sounding arguments. |
| 5 | <i>For though I be absent in the flesh, yet am I with you in the spirit, joying and beholding your order, and the stedfastness of your faith in Christ.</i> | For though I am absent from You in body, I am present with You in spirit and delight to see how disciplined You are and how firm Your faith in Christ is. |

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| 6 | <i>As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him:</i> | So then, just as You received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to live Your lives in Him, |
| 7 | <i>Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving.</i> | rooted and built up in Him, strengthened in the faith as You were taught, and overflowing with thankfulness. |
| 8 | <i>Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the rudiments of the world, and not after Christ.</i> | See to it that no one takes you captive through hollow and deceptive philosophy, which depends on human tradition and the elemental spiritual forces of this world rather than on Christ. |
| 9 | <i>For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.</i> | For in Christ all the fullness of the Godhead lives in bodily form, |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Godhead** (GOD-hed) — *the divine nature of God; the Trinity considered as one being. Paul says the entire Godhead — Father, Son, and Holy Ghost — fully dwells in bodily form in Jesus Christ. This is a key verse on Christ's full divinity.*

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| 10 | <i>And ye are complete in him, which is the head of all principality and power:</i> | and in Christ You have been brought to fullness. He is the head over every power and authority. |
| 11 | <i>In whom also ye are circumcised with the circumcision made without hands, in putting off the body of the sins of the flesh by the circumcision of Christ:</i> | In Him also You were circumcised with the circumcision made without hands, in putting off the body of the sins of the flesh by the circumcision of Christ, |
| 12 | <i>Buried with him in baptism, wherein also ye are risen with him through the faith of the operation of God, who hath raised him from the dead.</i> | having been buried with Him in baptism, in which You were also raised with Him through Your faith in the working of God, Who raised Him from the dead. |

- 13 *And you, being dead in your sins and the uncircumcision of your flesh, hath he quickened together with him, having forgiven you all trespasses;* When You were dead in Your sins and in the uncircumcision of Your flesh, God made You alive with Christ. He forgave us all our sins,
- 14 *Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances that was against us, which was contrary to us, and took it out of the way, nailing it to his cross;* having canceled the charge of our legal indebtedness, which stood against us and condemned us. He has taken it away, nailing it to the cross.
- 15 *And having spoiled principalities and powers, he made a shew of them openly, triumphing over them in it.* And having disarmed the powers and authorities, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross.
- 16 *Let no man therefore judge you in meat, or in drink, or in respect of an holyday, or of the new moon, or of the sabbath days:* Therefore do not let anyone judge you by what you eat or drink, or with regard to a religious festival, a New Moon celebration, or a Sabbath day.
- 17 *Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body is of Christ.* These are a shadow of the things that were to come; the reality, however, is found in Christ.
- 18 *Let no man beguile you of your reward in a voluntary humility and worshipping of angels, intruding into those things which he hath not seen, vainly puffed up by his fleshly mind,* Do not let anyone who delights in false humility and the worship of angels disqualify You. Such a person also goes into great detail about what they have seen; they are puffed up with idle notions by their unspiritual mind.
- 19 *And not holding the Head, from which all the body by joints and bands having nourishment ministered, and knit together, increaseth with the increase of God.* They have lost connection with the head, from whom the whole body, supported and held together by its ligaments and sinews, grows as God causes it to grow.
- 20 *Wherefore if ye be dead with Christ from the rudiments of the world, why, as though living in the world, are ye subject to ordinances,* Since You died with Christ to the elemental spiritual forces of this world, why, as though You still belonged to the world, do You submit to its rules:

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| 21 | <i>(Touch not; taste not; handle not;</i> | "Do not handle! Do not taste! Do not touch!"? |
| 22 | <i>Which all are to perish with the using;) after the commandments and doctrines of men?</i> | These rules, which have to do with things that all perish with use, are based on merely human commands and teachings. |
| 23 | <i>Which things have indeed a shew of wisdom in will worship, and humility, and neglecting of the body; not in any honour to the satisfying of the flesh.</i> | Such regulations indeed have an appearance of wisdom with their self-imposed worship, their false humility, and their harsh treatment of the body, but they lack any value in restraining sensual indulgence. |

Words in this chapter:

godhead — The divine nature of God — the Trinity considered as one being; God in His full divine essence.

quicken — Made alive — spiritually brought from death to life by God; used for resurrection and spiritual rebirth.

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

sabbath (*SAB-ath*) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Cross-References:

- v6** — Col 1:10; 1 John 2:6; 1 Thess 4:1; Eph 5:1-2; Gal 2:20
- v7** — Eph 3:17; Jer 17:8; Eph 2:20-22; John 15:4-5; Col 1:23
- v8** — 1 Tim 6:20; Eph 5:6; Matt 7:15; Gal 4:9; 1 Cor 3:18-19
- v9** — Col 1:19; John 1:14; John 10:30; 1 Tim 3:16; John 14:9-10
- v10** — Eph 3:19; Col 1:16-18; Eph 1:20-23; 1 Cor 1:30-31; 1 Pet 3:22
- v11** — Rom 2:29; Phil 3:3; Rom 6:6; Deut 30:6; Eph 4:22
- v12** — Rom 6:3-5; 1 Pet 3:21; Gal 3:27; Eph 2:4-6; Col 3:1-2
- v13** — Eph 2:5-6; Rom 8:11; Eph 2:1; 2 Cor 5:19; Heb 9:14
- v14** — Eph 2:14-16; Isa 44:22; Isa 43:25; Heb 8:13; 1 Pet 2:24
- v15** — Heb 2:14; Eph 4:8; Matt 12:29; John 12:31-32; Isa 53:12
- v16** — Rom 14:5-6; Rom 14:10; Rom 14:13-17; Gal 4:10; Rom 14:2-3
- v17** — Heb 10:1; Heb 8:5; John 1:17; Heb 9:9; Heb 4:1-11

Chapter 3

Paul instructs believers to set their affection on things above, to put to death the earthly members — fornication, uncleanness, evil desire, and covetousness — and to put on the new man renewed in knowledge after the image of Him who created him. He gives instructions for husbands and wives, parents and children, and servants and masters, teaching that whatever they do, they should do it heartily as to the Lord.

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| <p>1 <i>If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God.</i></p> | <p>Since, then, You have been raised with Christ, set Your hearts on things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth.</i></p> | <p>Set Your minds on things above, not on earthly things.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For ye are dead, and your life is hid with Christ in God.</i></p> | <p>For You died, and Your life is now hidden with Christ in God.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>When Christ, who is our life, shall appear, then shall ye also appear with him in glory.</i></p> | <p>When Christ, Who is Your life, appears, then You also will appear with Him in glory.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Mortify therefore your members which are upon the earth; fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil concupiscence, and covetousness, which is idolatry:</i></p> | <p>Mortify therefore Your members which are on the earth: fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil concupiscence, and covetousness, which is idolatry.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For which things' sake the wrath of God cometh on the children of disobedience:</i></p> | <p>Because of these, the wrath of God is coming on those who are disobedient.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>In the which ye also walked some time, when ye lived in them.</i></p> | <p>You used to walk in these ways, in the life You once lived.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>But now ye also put off all these; anger, wrath, malice, blasphemy, filthy communication out of your mouth.</i></p> | <p>But now You also put off all these: anger, wrath, malice, blasphemy, filthy communication out of Your mouth.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Lie not one to another, seeing that ye have put off the old man with his deeds;</i></p> | <p>Do not lie to each other, since You have taken off Your old self with its practices</p> |

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| <p>10 <i>And have put on the new man, which is renewed in knowledge after the image of him that created him:</i></p> <p>11 <i>Where there is neither Greek nor Jew, circumcision nor uncircumcision, Barbarian, Scythian, bond nor free: but Christ is all, and in all.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Put on therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, bowels of mercies, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, longsuffering;</i></p> <p>13 <i>Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another, if any man have a quarrel against any: even as Christ forgave you, so also do ye.</i></p> | <p>and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge in the image of its Creator.</p> <p>Here there is no Gentile or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave or free, but Christ is all, and is in all.</p> <p>Therefore, as God's chosen people, holy and dearly loved, clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and longsuffering.</p> <p>Bear with each other and forgive one another if any of You has a grievance against someone. Forgive as the Lord forgave you.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

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| <p>14 <i>And above all these things put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to the which also ye are called in one body; and be ye thankful.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.</i></p> | <p>And over all these virtues put on charity, which binds them all together in perfect unity.</p> <p>Let the peace of Christ rule in Your hearts, since as members of one body You were called to peace. And be thankful.</p> <p>Let the message of Christ dwell among You richly as You teach and admonish one another with all wisdom through psalms, hymns, and songs from the Spirit, singing to God with gratitude in Your hearts.</p> |
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| <p>17 <i>And whatsoever ye do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God and the Father by him.</i></p> <p>18 <i>Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as it is fit in the Lord.</i></p> <p>19 <i>Husbands, love your wives, and be not bitter against them.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Children, obey your parents in all things: for this is well pleasing unto the Lord.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Fathers, provoke not your children to anger, lest they be discouraged.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Servants, obey in all things your masters according to the flesh; not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but in singleness of heart, fearing God:</i></p> <p>23 <i>And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men;</i></p> <p>24 <i>Knowing that of the Lord ye shall receive the reward of the inheritance: for ye serve the Lord Christ.</i></p> <p>25 <i>But he that doeth wrong shall receive for the wrong which he hath done: and there is no respect of persons.</i></p> | <p>And whatever You do, whether in word or deed, do it all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through Him.</p> <p>Wives, submit yourselves to Your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord.</p> <p>Husbands, love Your wives and do not be harsh with them.</p> <p>Children, obey Your parents in everything, for this pleases the Lord.</p> <p>Fathers, do not embitter Your children, or they will become discouraged.</p> <p>Slaves, obey Your earthly masters in everything. Do it not only when they are watching — not to win their favor — but with sincerity of heart and reverence for the Lord.</p> <p>Whatever You do, work at it with all Your heart, as working for the Lord, not for human masters,</p> <p>since You know that You will receive an inheritance from the Lord as a reward. It is the Lord Christ You are serving.</p> <p>Anyone who does wrong will be repaid for their wrong, and there is no favoritism.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rom 8:6; Matt 6:33; 2 Cor 4:18; Col 3:2; Matt 6:20

v2 — 1 John 2:15-17; 1 Chr 22:19; Col 3:1; Matt 16:23; Rom 8:4-6
v3 — Gal 2:20; Rom 6:2; Col 2:20; John 5:24; Rom 5:10
v5 — Rom 8:13; Gal 5:19-21; Gal 5:24; 1 Pet 2:11; 1 Cor 6:9-10
v10 — Eph 4:23-24; Rom 12:2; Eph 2:10; 2 Cor 5:17; Col 3:12
v12 — Eph 4:32; Eph 4:2; 1 John 4:19; 2 Pet 1:5-8; Gal 5:22-23
v13 — Eph 4:32; Mark 11:25; Jas 2:13; Eph 4:2; Matt 6:14-15
v15 — Phil 4:6-7; John 14:27; Isa 26:3; Rom 15:13; Ps 29:11
v16 — Ps 119:11; Eph 5:19; John 15:7; Rom 10:17; Jer 15:16
v17 — 1 Cor 10:31; Col 3:23; Prov 3:6; Eph 5:20; 1 Thess 5:18
v19 — 1 Pet 3:7; Gen 2:23-24; Col 3:21; Eph 5:25; Eph 5:28-29
v23 — Col 3:17; Eph 6:6-7; Rom 14:8; 2 Chr 31:21; Eccl 9:10

Chapter 4

Paul instructs masters to treat their servants justly and urges the church to continue in prayer, to walk in wisdom toward outsiders, and to let their speech be always with grace seasoned with salt. He sends personal greetings from his companions, including Luke the beloved physician, and instructs the Colossians to exchange letters with the church at Laodicea.

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| 1 | <i>Masters, give unto your servants that which is just and equal; knowing that ye also have a Master in heaven.</i> | Masters, provide your slaves with what is right and fair, because you know that you also have a Master in heaven. |
| 2 | <i>Continue in prayer, and watch in the same with thanksgiving;</i> | Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful. |
| 3 | <i>Withal praying also for us, that God would open unto us a door of utterance, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds:</i> | And pray for us, too, that God may open a door for our message, so that we may proclaim the mystery of Christ, for which I am in chains. |
| 4 | <i>That I may make it manifest, as I ought to speak.</i> | Pray that I may proclaim it clearly, as I should. |
| 5 | <i>Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time.</i> | Be wise in the way You act toward outsiders; make the most of every opportunity. |
| 6 | <i>Let your speech be alway with grace, seasoned with salt, that ye may know how ye ought to answer every man.</i> | Let Your conversation be always full of grace, seasoned with salt, so that You may know how to answer everyone. |

- 7 *All my state shall Tychicus declare unto you, who is a beloved brother, and a faithful minister and fellowservant in the Lord:* Tychicus will tell you all the news about me. He is a dear brother, a faithful minister, and a fellow servant in the Lord.
- 8 *Whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that he might know your estate, and comfort your hearts;* I am sending Him to You for the express purpose that You may know about our circumstances and that He may encourage Your hearts.
- 9 *With Onesimus, a faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They shall make known unto you all things which are done here.* He is coming with Onesimus, our faithful and dear brother, who is one of You. They will tell You everything that is happening here.
- 10 *Aristarchus my fellowprisoner saluteth you, and Marcus, sister's son to Barnabas, (touching whom ye received commandments: if he come unto you, receive him;)* My fellow prisoner Aristarchus sends you his greetings, as does Mark, the cousin of Barnabas. You have received instructions about him; if he comes to you, welcome him.
- 11 *And Jesus, which is called Justus, who are of the circumcision. These only are my fellowworkers unto the kingdom of God, which have been a comfort unto me.* Jesus, Who is called Justus, also sends greetings. These are the only Jews among my co-workers for the kingdom of God, and they have proved a comfort to me.
- 12 *Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Christ Jesus, saluteth you, always labouring fervently for you in prayers, that ye may stand perfect and complete in all the will of God.* Epaphras, who is one of You and a servant of Christ Jesus, sends greetings. He is always wrestling in prayer for You, that You may stand firm in all the will of God, mature and fully assured.
- 13 *For I bear him record, that he hath a great zeal for you, and them that are in Laodicea, and them in Hierapolis.* I vouch for Him that He is working hard for You and for those at Laodicea and Hierapolis.
- 14 *Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas, greet you.* Our dear friend Luke, the doctor, and Demas send greetings.

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| 15 <i>Salute the brethren which are in Laodicea, and Nymphas, and the church which is in his house.</i> | Give my greetings to the brothers and sisters at Laodicea, and to Nympha and the church in her house. |
| 16 <i>And when this epistle is read among you, cause that it be read also in the church of the Laodiceans; and that ye likewise read the epistle from Laodicea.</i> | After this letter has been read to You, see that it is also read in the church of the Laodiceans and that You in turn read the letter from Laodicea. |
| 17 <i>And say to Archippus, Take heed to the ministry which thou hast received in the Lord, that thou fulfil it.</i> | Tell Archippus: "See to it that You complete the ministry You have received in the Lord." |
| 18 <i>The salutation by the hand of me Paul. Remember my bonds. Grace be with you. Amen.</i> | I, Paul, write this greeting in my own hand. Remember my chains. Grace be with you. |

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Barnabas (*BAR-nah-bas*) — Paul's early missionary companion — his given name was Joseph, but the apostles called him Barnabas ('son of encouragement') because of his generous and encouraging character.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Eph 6:8-20; Jas 2:13; Rev 17:14; Deut 24:14-15; Luke 16:1-13
- v2** — 1 Thess 5:17-18; Phil 4:6; Eph 6:18; Rom 12:12; Matt 26:41
- v3** — Eph 6:19-20; Acts 14:27; 2 Thess 3:1-2; Phil 1:13-14; 2 Cor 2:12
- v5** — Eph 5:15-17; Jas 3:13; 1 Thess 4:12; Jas 3:17; Rom 16:19
- v6** — Eph 4:29; 1 Pet 3:15; Eccl 10:12; Mark 9:50; Prov 15:4
- v7** — Eph 6:21-23; Acts 20:4; 2 Tim 4:12
- v10** — Acts 19:29; Phlm 1:24; 2 Tim 4:11
- v11** — Acts 11:2; 1 Thess 3:2; Titus 1:10; Phlm 1:24; Acts 10:45
- v12** — Rom 15:30; Col 1:9; Col 1:7; Phlm 1:23; Col 1:28
- v16** — 1 Thess 5:27; 2 Thess 3:14
- v17** — Phlm 1:2; Acts 1:17; 2 Chr 29:11; 1 Tim 4:16; 1 Tim 4:6
- v18** — Heb 13:3; 1 Tim 6:21; 1 Cor 16:21; 2 Tim 4:22

1 Thessalonians

Author: Paul the apostle, with Silvanus (Silas) and Timothy joining in the greeting (1:1). The letter is consistently in the first-person plural — Paul writes as part of a missionary team.

Date written: c. AD 50–51, from Corinth on Paul's second missionary journey. It is one of the earliest books of the New Testament — only Galatians and James may predate it.

Written to: The young church at Thessalonica, capital of the Roman province of Macedonia (modern Thessaloniki). Paul had only been there a few weeks (Acts 17:1–9) before being driven out by hostile Jews. He had been worried about whether the new converts would survive the persecution that followed.

Setting: Paul, separated from the Thessalonians, had sent Timothy back to check on them (3:1–2). Timothy returned to him at Corinth with good news of their continued faith. Paul writes this letter both to commend their endurance under persecution and to answer pastoral questions they had raised: (1) What happens to fellow believers who have died — will they miss the Lord's coming? (2) When will Christ return? (3) How should the church live in the meantime?

Where this sits historically: Written from Corinth under Claudius, around the same time Gallio served as proconsul of Achaia (Acts 18) — one of the earliest NT books, roughly twenty years after the resurrection.

Contemporaries: Silas and Timothy were Paul's coworkers at Corinth as the letter was sent, and 2 Thessalonians and possibly Galatians and James were composed in the same general window.

Big themes:

- The church's faith, love, and patient hope under persecution
- Paul's pastoral heart — his "absent in body, present in spirit" affection for them
- Sexual purity in the middle of a pagan culture
- Brotherly love and quiet, diligent work
- The Lord's return — the dead in Christ raised first, then those still alive caught up to meet Him in the air
- The day of the Lord, coming like a thief in the night
- Preparation through holy living
- The trinitarian benediction (5:23)
- The rapid-fire closing imperatives (5:16–22)

Key passages: 1 Thess 1:9–10 (turned to God from idols); 4:13–18 (the rapture passage); 5:1–11 (the day of the Lord); 5:16–22 (rapid imperatives); 5:23 (sanctification benediction).

How it fits: 1 Thessalonians is one of the earliest NT books and the first major NT passage on the rapture and the resurrection of the saints. Together with 2 Thessalonians, it forms the

earliest sustained NT teaching on the last things. The closing imperatives in 5:16–22 — "Rejoice evermore. Pray without ceasing." — are among the most quoted verses for daily Christian living.

> ■ **NAME NOTE** — **Paul** (PAWL) — "small, little" — Formerly Saul of Tarsus; a Pharisee who persecuted the church before Christ met him on the road to Damascus (Acts 9). Now an apostle to the Gentiles. He founded the Thessalonian church on his second missionary journey (Acts 17:1–9).

> ■ **NAME NOTE** — **Thessalonica** (thes-uh-loh-NY-kuh) — Capital of the Roman province of Macedonia and a major seaport on the Via Egnatia. Paul preached here for only a few weeks before a Jewish mob drove him out (Acts 17:1–9). The young church he left behind is the recipient of this letter.

Chapter 1

Paul gives thanks for the Thessalonians, remembering their work of faith, labour of love, and patience of hope in the Lord Jesus Christ. He recalls how the gospel came to them not in word only but also in power and in the Holy Ghost, and how they turned from idols to serve the living and true God and to wait for His Son from heaven.

- 1 Paul, and Silvanus, and Timotheus, From Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy —
unto the church of the Thessalonians to the church of the Thessalonians,
which is in God the Father and in the which is in God the Father and in the
Lord Jesus Christ: Grace be unto you, Lord Jesus Christ. Grace and peace to
and peace, from God our Father, and You from God our Father and the Lord
the Lord Jesus Christ. Jesus Christ.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Silvanus** (sil-VAY-nus) — also called **Silas** in Acts — A leading member of the Jerusalem church (Acts 15:22) chosen by Paul as his partner on the second missionary journey. He was with Paul in Thessalonica when this church was founded. KJV uses the Latin form Silvanus in the epistles; modern translations and Acts use Silas.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Timothy** (TIM-oh-thee) — also **Timotheus** in KJV — "honoring God" — Paul's young protégé from Lystra (Acts 16:1–3), son of a Jewish mother and a Greek father. Paul sent Timothy back to Thessalonica to check on the church under persecution (3:1–6); his good report is the immediate occasion for this letter. KJV uses the Greek form Timotheus; the modern column uses the universally-known Timothy.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Brethren** (BREH-thren) — KJV's plural for "brothers" in the church family. In the New Testament it regularly means "fellow believers" of both sexes — not only men. The modern column keeps the KJV word brethren because of how heavily it is used in Paul's letters; read it as "brothers and sisters in Christ."

- 2

We give thanks to God always for you all, making mention of you in our prayers;

We always thank God for You all, mentioning You in our prayers,
- 3

Remembering without ceasing your work of faith, and labour of love, and patience of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ, in the sight of God and our Father;

constantly remembering before our God and Father Your work that flows from faith, Your labor that flows from love, and Your patient endurance that flows from hope in our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 4

Knowing, brethren beloved, your election of God.

We know, brethren loved by God, that He has chosen You.
- 5

For our gospel came not unto you in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Ghost, and in much assurance; as ye know what manner of men we were among you for your sake.

Our gospel did not come to You in word only, but also in power, in the Holy Ghost, and with deep conviction. You know the kind of men we were among You for Your sake.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the older English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is not a force or an influence — He is a Person, fully God, who dwells in every believer and gives power for life and witness.

- 6

And ye became followers of us, and of the Lord, having received the word in much affliction, with joy of the Holy Ghost:

And You became followers of us and of the Lord, receiving the word in much affliction, with the joy of the Holy Ghost,
- 7

So that ye were ensamples to all that believe in Macedonia and Achaia.

so that You became examples to all who believe in Macedonia and Achaia.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Macedonia** (mas-eh-DOH-nee-uh) — The Roman province covering northern Greece. Paul received a vision of a Macedonian man calling for help (Acts 16:9), and through that vision the gospel first entered Europe. Its leading cities were Philippi, Thessalonica, and Berea.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Achaia** (uh-KAY-uh) — *The Roman province covering southern Greece, including Corinth and Athens. Together, Macedonia and Achaia made up the whole of Greek territory under Rome. The Thessalonians' faith had become famous in both provinces.*

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| 8 | <i>For from you sounded out the word of the Lord not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but also in every place your faith to God-ward is spread abroad; so that we need not to speak any thing.</i> | For from You the word of the Lord has rung out — not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but in every place. Your faith toward God has spread so far that we do not need to say anything. |
| 9 | <i>For they themselves shew of us what manner of entering in we had unto you, and how ye turned to God from idols to serve the living and true God;</i> | People themselves report about us what kind of welcome we had among You, and how You turned to God from idols to serve the living and true God, |
| 10 | <i>And to wait for his Son from heaven, whom he raised from the dead, even Jesus, which delivered us from the wrath to come.</i> | and to wait for His Son from heaven, whom He raised from the dead — Jesus, Who delivers us from the wrath to come. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 1:7; 2 Thess 1:1
- v2 — Rom 1:8-9; Eph 1:15-16; Phlm 1:4; Col 1:3; Phil 1:3-4
- v3 — 1 Cor 13:13; Rev 2:19; Gal 5:6; Rom 8:24-25; 2 Thess 1:11
- v4 — 2 Thess 2:13; 2 Pet 1:10; Titus 3:4-5; Rom 9:25; Col 3:12
- v5 — 2 Thess 3:7-9; Mark 16:20; 1 Cor 2:2-5; 2 Thess 2:14; 1 Thess 2:13
- v6 — 1 Cor 11:1; 1 Cor 4:16; Acts 13:52; Gal 5:22; 2 Thess 3:9
- v7 — Titus 2:7; 1 Pet 5:3; 1 Tim 4:12
- v8 — Rom 1:8; Rom 10:14-18
- v9 — 1 Tim 4:10; 1 Cor 12:2; Gal 4:8-9
- v10 — 1 Thess 5:9; Isa 25:8-9; Rom 5:9-10; Matt 3:7; Acts 2:24

Chapter 2

Paul reminds the Thessalonians that he and his companions were bold to speak the gospel amid much opposition, never using flattery or seeking glory from men. He recalls how he was gentle among them as a nursing mother cherishes her children, and how the Thessalonians received the word not as the word of men but as the word of God, which effectually works in

those who believe.

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| 1 <i>For yourselves, brethren, know our entrance in unto you, that it was not in vain:</i> | For you yourselves, brethren, know that our coming to you was not in vain. |
| 2 <i>But even after that we had suffered before, and were shamefully entreated, as ye know, at Philippi, we were bold in our God to speak unto you the gospel of God with much contention.</i> | Though we had already suffered and been shamefully treated at Philippi, as you know, we were bold in our God to speak to you the gospel of God in the face of strong opposition. |
| 3 <i>For our exhortation was not of deceit, nor of uncleanness, nor in guile:</i> | For our appeal was not made out of deceit, or uncleanness, or trickery. |
| 4 <i>But as we were allowed of God to be put in trust with the gospel, even so we speak; not as pleasing men, but God, which trieth our hearts.</i> | But just as we have been approved by God to be entrusted with the gospel, so we speak — not to please men, but God, Who tests our hearts. |
| 5 <i>For neither at any time used we flattering words, as ye know, nor a cloke of covetousness; God is witness:</i> | For we never used flattering words, as you know, nor any cover-up for greed — God is our witness. |
| 6 <i>Nor of men sought we glory, neither of you, nor yet of others, when we might have been burdensome, as the apostles of Christ.</i> | Nor did we seek glory from men — not from You, nor from anyone else — though as apostles of Christ we could have made demands of You. |
| 7 <i>But we were gentle among you, even as a nurse cherisheth her children:</i> | Instead, we were gentle among You, like a nursing mother caring for her own children. |
| 8 <i>So being affectionately desirous of you, we were willing to have imparted unto you, not the gospel of God only, but also our own souls, because ye were dear unto us.</i> | Because we loved You so dearly, we were delighted to share with You not only the gospel of God, but our own lives as well, because You had become dear to us. |

- 9 *For ye remember, brethren, our labour and travail: for labouring night and day, because we would not be chargeable unto any of you, we preached unto you the gospel of God.* For You remember, brethren, our labor and toil. We worked night and day so that we would not be a burden to any of You while we preached the gospel of God to You.
- 10 *Ye are witnesses, and God also, how holily and justly and unblameably we behaved ourselves among you that believe:* You are witnesses, and God is also, how holy, just, and blameless our conduct was among You who believe —
- 11 *As ye know how we exhorted and comforted and charged every one of you, as a father doth his children,* just as You know how, like a father with His own children, we exhorted, comforted, and charged every one of you,
- 12 *That ye would walk worthy of God, who hath called you unto his kingdom and glory.* that You would walk worthy of God, Who has called You into His own kingdom and glory.
- 13 *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because, when ye received the word of God which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God, which effectually worketh also in you that believe.* For this reason we also thank God without ceasing: when You received the word of God which You heard from us, You welcomed it not as the word of men, but as it truly is — the word of God, which is at work in You who believe.
- 14 *For ye, brethren, became followers of the churches of God which in Judaea are in Christ Jesus: for ye also have suffered like things of your own countrymen, even as they have of the Jews:* For You, brethren, became followers of the churches of God in Judaea that are in Christ Jesus. You have suffered the same things from Your own countrymen that they have suffered from the Jews —
- 15 *Who both killed the Lord Jesus, and their own prophets, and have persecuted us; and they please not God, and are contrary to all men:* the Jews who killed both the Lord Jesus and their own prophets, and have driven us out. They do not please God, and they are hostile to all men,

- 16 *Forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles that they might be saved, to fill up their sins alway: for the wrath is come upon them to the uttermost.* forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles so that they might be saved. So they keep filling up the measure of their sins; but the wrath has come upon them at last.
- 17 *But we, brethren, being taken from you for a short time in presence, not in heart, endeavoured the more abundantly to see your face with great desire.* But we, brethren, having been torn away from You for a short time — in presence, not in heart — were all the more eager and full of desire to see Your face again.
- 18 *Wherefore we would have come unto you, even I Paul, once and again; but Satan hindered us.* Therefore we wanted to come to you — I, Paul, again and again — but Satan hindered us.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Satan** (SAY-tun) — "adversary" — *The chief fallen angel; the deceiver and accuser of God's people, the personal enemy of God and of the saints. Here Paul attributes the obstacles to his return to Satan's direct opposition. Scripture treats Satan as a real and active person, not a symbol — but always already defeated by Christ.*

- 19 *For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? Are not even ye in the presence of our Lord Jesus Christ at his coming?* For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? Is it not You — in the presence of our Lord Jesus Christ at His coming?
- 20 *For ye are our glory and joy.* For You are our glory and joy.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v4 — Gal 1:10; Rom 8:27; Gal 2:7; 2 Tim 1:14; Ps 17:3
v6 — Gal 1:10; John 5:44; John 5:41; 1 Thess 2:9; Phlm 1:8-9
v7 — Isa 66:13; 2 Tim 2:24-25; 1 Thess 2:11; Isa 49:23; 2 Cor 10:1
v8 — 1 John 3:16; 2 Cor 12:15; Phil 2:17; Rom 1:11-12
v9 — 2 Thess 3:7-9; 2 Cor 11:9; Acts 18:3; 2 Cor 12:13-14
v12 — Eph 4:1; 1 John 2:6; 1 John 1:6-7; 2 Thess 2:13-14; 1 Thess 4:12
v13 — Heb 4:12; Rom 10:17; 1 Pet 1:23; 1 Pet 1:25; 1 Pet 2:2
v14 — 1 Thess 3:4; Heb 10:33-34; Heb 5:7-8; 2 Thess 1:4; 2 Cor 8:1-2
v15 — Matt 5:12; Acts 7:52; Luke 11:48-53; Acts 2:23; Luke 13:33-34
v17 — Col 2:5; 1 Cor 5:3; 1 Thess 3:6; 1 Thess 3:10-11; Rom 1:13
v18 — Rom 15:22; Rom 1:13; Rev 2:10; 2 Cor 11:12-14; Zech 3:1-2

v19 — Phil 4:1; 1 Thess 3:13; 1 Thess 5:23; Phil 2:16; 2 Cor 1:14

Chapter 3

Paul sent Timothy to Thessalonica to strengthen and encourage the believers in their afflictions, and Timothy returned with good news of their faith and love. Paul expresses great joy over their steadfastness and prays night and day that he may see them again and supply what is lacking in their faith.

- 1

Wherefore when we could no longer forbear, we thought it good to be left at Athens alone;

Therefore, when we could no longer endure not knowing, we thought it good to be left at Athens alone,
- NAME NOTE — Athens (ATH-enz) — The intellectual capital of ancient Greece, in the Roman province of Achaia. Paul preached on the Areopagus (Mars Hill) there about the "unknown god" (Acts 17:16–34). It was from Athens that he sent Timothy back to Thessalonica.
- 2

And sent Timotheus, our brother, and minister of God, and our fellowlabourer in the gospel of Christ, to establish you, and to comfort you concerning your faith:

and we sent Timothy — our brother and a minister of God and our fellow worker in the gospel of Christ — to strengthen You and comfort You concerning Your faith,
- 3

That no man should be moved by these afflictions: for yourselves know that we are appointed thereunto.

so that no one would be shaken by these afflictions. For you yourselves know that we are appointed to this.
- 4

For verily, when we were with you, we told you before that we should suffer tribulation; even as it came to pass, and ye know.

For truly, when we were with You, we told You in advance that we were going to suffer tribulation, just as it has happened — and You know it.
- 5

For this cause, when I could no longer forbear, I sent to know your faith, lest by some means the tempter have tempted you, and our labour be in vain.

For this reason, when I could no longer endure not knowing, I sent to find out about Your faith — fearing that the tempter might have tempted You and that our labor would be in vain.

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| <p>6 <i>But now when Timotheus came from you unto us, and brought us good tidings of your faith and charity, and that ye have good remembrance of us always, desiring greatly to see us, as we also to see you:</i></p> | <p>But now Timothy has just come back to us from you, and has brought us good news of your faith and charity. He tells us that you remember us kindly always, longing to see us, just as we also long to see you.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

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| <p>7 <i>Therefore, brethren, we were comforted over you in all our affliction and distress by your faith:</i></p> | <p>Therefore, brethren, in all our distress and affliction we were comforted concerning you by your faith.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>For now we live, if ye stand fast in the Lord.</i></p> | <p>For now we live — if you stand fast in the Lord.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>For what thanks can we render to God again for you, for all the joy wherewith we joy for your sakes before our God;</i></p> | <p>For what thanks can we give back to God for you, for all the joy with which we rejoice over you before our God,</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Night and day praying exceedingly that we might see your face, and might perfect that which is lacking in your faith?</i></p> | <p>as night and day we pray most earnestly that we might see your face and supply what is lacking in your faith?</p> |
| <p>11 <i>Now God himself and our Father, and our Lord Jesus Christ, direct our way unto you.</i></p> | <p>Now may God Himself and our Father, and our Lord Jesus Christ, direct our way to You.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>And the Lord make you to increase and abound in love one toward another, and toward all men, even as we do toward you:</i></p> | <p>And may the Lord make You increase and overflow in love toward one another, and toward all men, just as we do toward You,</p> |
| <p>13 <i>To the end he may stablish your hearts unblameable in holiness before God, even our Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ with all his saints.</i></p> | <p>so that He may establish Your hearts blameless in holiness before God, our Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ with all His saints.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 17:15; 1 Thess 3:5
- v2 — Acts 14:22-23; Eph 6:21-22
- v3 — Acts 14:22; Rom 5:3; Acts 9:16; John 16:33; 1 Cor 15:58
- v4 — 1 Thess 2:14; 2 Cor 8:1-2
- v5 — Jas 1:13-14; Matt 4:3
- v6 — 1 Cor 11:2; Isa 52:7
- v8 — Col 1:23; 1 Cor 16:13; Rev 3:11
- v9 — 2 Cor 9:15; Ps 96:12-13
- v10 — 2 Cor 13:9; Rom 1:10-12; Rom 15:30-32; Phil 1:25; 2 Cor 1:24
- v11 — Prov 3:5-6; Matt 6:32
- v12 — Phil 1:9; Rom 13:8; 1 John 4:7-16; Matt 22:39; 2 Thess 1:3
- v13 — Col 1:22; 1 Thess 5:23; Eph 5:27; 1 Thess 2:19; Jude 1:14

Chapter 4

Paul urges the Thessalonians to abstain from fornication, to live quietly, work with their own hands, and walk honestly toward those outside. He comforts them concerning the dead in Christ, declaring that the Lord Himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, and the dead in Christ shall rise first, then the living shall be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air.

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| 1 | <i>Furthermore then we beseech you, brethren, and exhort you by the Lord Jesus, that as ye have received of us how ye ought to walk and to please God, so ye would abound more and more.</i> | Finally then, brethren, we appeal to You and urge You in the Lord Jesus that, just as You received from us how You ought to walk and to please God, You would do so more and more. |
| 2 | <i>For ye know what commandments we gave you by the Lord Jesus.</i> | For You know what commandments we gave You through the Lord Jesus. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctification** (SANK-tih-fih-KAY-shun) — being made holy. Sanctification is the lifelong work of God in a believer, setting him apart from sin and shaping him to look like Christ. It is not the moment of conversion (that is justification) — it is the long, daily process of becoming what God has already declared us to be in Christ.

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| 3 | <i>For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication:</i> | For this is the will of God — your sanctification: that You abstain from fornication, |
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- 4 *That every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour;* that each of You should know how to control His own body in sanctification and honor,
- 5 *Not in the lust of concupiscence, even as the Gentiles which know not God:* not in the lust of evil desire, like the Gentiles who do not know God;
- 6 *That no man go beyond and defraud his brother in any matter: because that the Lord is the avenger of all such, as we also have forewarned you and testified.* and that no man overstep or take advantage of His brother in this matter, because the Lord is the avenger of all such sins, as we have already warned You and solemnly testified.
- 7 *For God hath not called us unto uncleanness, but unto holiness.* For God has not called us to uncleanness, but to holiness.
- 8 *He therefore that despiseth, despiseth not man, but God, who hath also given unto us his holy Spirit.* Therefore the one who rejects this teaching is not rejecting man, but God — who has also given to us His Holy Spirit.
- 9 *But as touching brotherly love ye need not that I write unto you: for ye yourselves are taught of God to love one another.* Now concerning brotherly love, You have no need that I write to You, for You yourselves are taught by God to love one another.
- 10 *And indeed ye do it toward all the brethren which are in all Macedonia: but we beseech you, brethren, that ye increase more and more;* And indeed You do this toward all the brethren throughout Macedonia. But we appeal to You, brethren, to do so more and more —
- 11 *And that ye study to be quiet, and to do your own business, and to work with your own hands, as we commanded you;* and to make it Your ambition to lead a quiet life, to mind Your own business, and to work with Your own hands, just as we commanded You,
- 12 *That ye may walk honestly toward them that are without, and that ye may have lack of nothing.* so that You may walk honorably toward those who are outside, and that You may lack nothing.

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| 13 | <i>But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope.</i> | But I would not have You ignorant, brethren, concerning those who are asleep, so that You do not grieve like the rest of men, who have no hope. |
| 14 | <i>For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.</i> | For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, in the same way God will bring with Him those also who sleep in Jesus. |
| 15 | <i>For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep.</i> | For this we say to You by the word of the Lord: we who are alive and remain to the coming of the Lord shall not precede those who are asleep. |
| 16 | <i>For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first:</i> | For the Lord Himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God; and the dead in Christ shall rise first. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Trump of God (TRUMP)** — KJV's word for "trumpet." At Christ's coming a great trumpet blast announces His return and signals the resurrection of the dead in Christ. The "trump of God" is no human horn — it is heaven's own summons, sounded by God Himself, gathering His people to Himself at the last day.

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| 17 | <i>Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord.</i> | Then we who are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air; and so shall we ever be with the Lord. |
| 18 | <i>Wherefore comfort one another with these words.</i> | Therefore comfort one another with these words. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Col 1:10; 2 Thess 1:3; 2 Pet 3:18; Heb 13:16; 2 Pet 1:5-10
- v3 — 1 Pet 4:2; Rom 12:2; 1 Thess 5:23; Heb 13:4; Eph 5:17
- v6 — Heb 13:4; Ex 20:17; Ex 20:15; Rom 12:19; Prov 28:24

v7 — Lev 11:44; 1 Pet 2:9-12; Eph 1:4; 1 Pet 1:14-16; Lev 19:2
v9 — 1 John 3:11; Rom 12:10; 1 John 3:23; Heb 13:1; John 13:34-35
v11 — Eph 4:28; Eccl 4:6; 1 Pet 3:4; Titus 3:14; Prov 17:1
v12 — Col 4:5; 1 Pet 2:12; Rom 12:17; 1 Tim 3:7; Rom 13:13
v13 — Dan 12:2; 1 Thess 4:15; 1 Thess 5:10; 2 Pet 3:4; 1 Cor 15:18-19
v14 — Rom 8:11; Phil 3:20-21; Isa 26:19; 2 Cor 4:13-14; 1 Thess 4:13
v15 — 1 Cor 15:51-53; 2 Cor 4:14
v16 — 1 Cor 15:51-52; Matt 24:30-31; Rev 1:7; 1 Cor 15:23; Matt 16:27
v17 — 1 Cor 15:52; Rev 11:12; John 14:3; 1 Thess 4:15; Rev 1:7

Chapter 5

Paul warns that the day of the Lord comes as a thief in the night, bringing sudden destruction on those who say "peace and safety," but believers are children of the light and should watch and be sober. He gives final instructions: rejoice evermore, pray without ceasing, give thanks in everything, quench not the Spirit, prove all things, and hold fast that which is good.

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| 1 | <i>But of the times and the seasons, brethren, ye have no need that I write unto you.</i> | But of the times and the seasons, brethren, You have no need that anything be written to You. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **The Day of the Lord (DAY)** — A great Bible phrase running from Joel through Revelation. It is the day when God acts in final judgment on the wicked and final salvation for His people. In the OT it is "the Day of the LORD" — the day Jehovah comes. In the NT, the day of the Lord comes through the return of Christ. The phrase covers both the judgment and the deliverance — wrath for the world, salvation for the saints.

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| 2 | <i>For yourselves know perfectly that the day of the Lord so cometh as a thief in the night.</i> | For You yourselves know perfectly that the day of the Lord so comes as a thief in the night. |
| 3 | <i>For when they shall say, Peace and safety; then sudden destruction cometh upon them, as travail upon a woman with child; and they shall not escape.</i> | When they shall say, "Peace and safety," then sudden destruction comes upon them, like labor pains upon a woman with child — and they shall not escape. |
| 4 | <i>But ye, brethren, are not in darkness, that that day should overtake you as a thief.</i> | But You, brethren, are not in darkness, that that day should overtake You like a thief. |
| 5 | <i>Ye are all the children of light, and the children of the day: we are not of the night, nor of darkness.</i> | You are all children of light and children of the day. We are not of the night or of darkness. |

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| <p>6 <i>Therefore let us not sleep, as do others; but let us watch and be sober.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For they that sleep sleep in the night; and they that be drunken are drunken in the night.</i></p> <p>8 <i>But let us, who are of the day, be sober, putting on the breastplate of faith and love; and for an helmet, the hope of salvation.</i></p> <p>9 <i>For God hath not appointed us to wrath, but to obtain salvation by our Lord Jesus Christ,</i></p> <p>10 <i>Who died for us, that, whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with him.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Wherefore comfort yourselves together, and edify one another, even as also ye do.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And we beseech you, brethren, to know them which labour among you, and are over you in the Lord, and admonish you;</i></p> <p>13 <i>And to esteem them very highly in love for their work's sake. And be at peace among yourselves.</i></p> | <p>Therefore let us not sleep as others do, but let us watch and be sober.</p> <p>For those who sleep, sleep at night; and those who get drunk, get drunk at night.</p> <p>But let us, who are of the day, be sober — putting on the breastplate of faith and love, and for a helmet the hope of salvation.</p> <p>For God has not appointed us to wrath, but to obtain salvation by our Lord Jesus Christ,</p> <p>who died for us, so that whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with Him.</p> <p>Therefore encourage one another and build one another up, just as You are already doing.</p> <p>And we appeal to You, brethren, to recognize those who labor among You, and are over You in the Lord, and admonish You,</p> <p>and to esteem them very highly in love for their work's sake. And be at peace among yourselves.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — *patient with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. Longsuffering is more than ordinary patience — it is the steady refusal to grow bitter or to repay wrong with wrong, even when one is wronged again and again. KJV uses this word of God Himself (Ex 34:6; Rom 2:4) and commands it of believers toward each other.*

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| <p>14 <i>Now we exhort you, brethren, warn them that are unruly, comfort the feebleminded, support the weak, be patient toward all men.</i></p> | <p>Now we urge You, brethren, warn those who are unruly, comfort the fainthearted, support the weak, be longsuffering toward all men.</p> |
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| 15 <i>See that none render evil for evil unto any man; but ever follow that which is good, both among yourselves, and to all men.</i> | See that no one repays evil for evil to anyone; but always pursue what is good, both among yourselves and toward all. |
| 16 <i>Rejoice evermore.</i> | Rejoice always. |
| 17 <i>Pray without ceasing.</i> | Pray without ceasing. |
| 18 <i>In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.</i> | In everything give thanks. For this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning You. |
| 19 <i>Quench not the Spirit.</i> | Do not quench the Spirit. |
| 20 <i>Despise not prophesyings.</i> | Do not despise prophesyings. |
| 21 <i>Prove all things; hold fast that which is good.</i> | Test all things; hold fast what is good. |
| 22 <i>Abstain from all appearance of evil.</i> | Abstain from every appearance of evil. |
| 23 <i>And the very God of peace sanctify you wholly; and I pray God your whole spirit and soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.</i> | And the very God of peace sanctify You wholly; and may Your whole spirit and soul and body be preserved blameless to the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| 24 <i>Faithful is he that calleth you, who also will do it.</i> | Faithful is He who calls you, who also will do it. |
| 25 <i>Brethren, pray for us.</i> | Brethren, pray for us. |
| 26 <i>Greet all the brethren with an holy kiss.</i> | Greet all the brethren with a holy kiss. |
| 27 <i>I charge you by the Lord that this epistle be read unto all the holy brethren.</i> | I charge You by the Lord that this epistle be read to all the holy brethren. |
| 28 <i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.</i> | The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with You. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2** — Rev 16:15; 2 Pet 3:10; Matt 24:42-44; Rev 3:3; Matt 25:13
v3 — Luke 21:34-35; Matt 24:37-39; Luke 17:26-30; Rev 18:7-8; Ps 73:18-20
v11 — Eph 4:29; Rom 15:2; Heb 10:25; Heb 3:13; 1 Thess 4:18
v12 — Heb 13:17; Heb 13:7; 1 Tim 5:17-18; 1 Cor 16:18; 1 Cor 16:16
v15 — 1 Pet 3:9; Gal 6:10; Lev 19:18; 3 John 1:11; Rom 12:17-21
v16 — Rom 12:12; Phil 4:4; Matt 5:12; 2 Cor 6:10; Luke 10:20
v17 — Rom 12:12; Col 4:2; Eph 6:18; Luke 18:1; Luke 21:36
v18 — Eph 5:20; Phil 4:6; Col 3:17; Heb 13:15; Job 1:21
v19 — Eph 4:30; Acts 7:51; 2 Tim 1:6; 1 Tim 4:14; Isa 63:10
v21 — 1 John 4:1; Rom 12:2; Eph 5:10; Luke 12:57; Acts 17:11
v23 — Jude 1:24; Heb 4:12; 1 Cor 1:8-9; 1 Thess 3:13; 1 Pet 5:10
v24 — 2 Thess 3:3; Num 23:19; Deut 7:9; 1 Cor 1:9; 2 Tim 2:13

2 Thessalonians

Author: Paul the apostle, with Silvanus (Silas) and Timotheus (Timothy) joining him in the opening greeting (1:1). At the close, Paul writes the final salutation "with mine own hand" (3:17) as the authenticating mark of every genuine letter from him — almost certainly because a forged letter claiming to be from Paul had reached the Thessalonians (2:2).

Date written: c. AD 51–52, from Corinth, only a few months after 1 Thessalonians. Paul is still on the second missionary journey.

Written to: The church at Thessalonica, a leading city of Macedonia. Paul had evangelized there only briefly on his second missionary journey (Acts 17:1–9) before being driven out by hostile Jews. The young church had remained dear to him, and 1 Thessalonians had been written to comfort them about loved ones who had died and to teach them about the Lord's return.

Setting: After 1 Thessalonians, the situation in Thessalonica had grown worse rather than better. False teaching — possibly carried by a forged letter pretending to come from Paul — was now claiming that "the day of Christ is at hand," meaning it had already arrived. The Thessalonians were unsettled and shaken. Worse, some had stopped working entirely; they were living as busybodies on the church's charity, expecting Christ at any moment. Paul writes to correct the error and to issue a sharp command: the day of Christ cannot come until certain events first take place — a great falling away, and the revelation of the man of sin — and meanwhile every brother must work for his own bread.

Where this sits historically: Written from Corinth in the late reign of Claudius, only months after 1 Thessalonians and just before Nero's accession in AD 54.

Contemporaries: Silas and Timothy were still with Paul at Corinth, and the recently written 1 Thessalonians was already circulating among the Macedonian churches.

Big themes: the persecuted church will be vindicated when Christ returns in flaming fire to take vengeance on its enemies; the day of Christ has NOT already come; a great falling away (apostasy) must precede that day; the man of sin — the son of perdition — must be revealed before Christ comes; the Lord will consume that Wicked one with the spirit of His mouth and destroy him with the brightness of His coming; God has from the beginning chosen His people to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit; the duty of orderly work; church discipline for the disorderly.

Key passages: 2 Thess 1:7–10 (the revelation of Christ in flaming fire); 2:1–12 (the man of sin); 2:13–17 (chosen to salvation through sanctification); 3:10–13 (the command to work).

How it fits: 2 Thessalonians is the chief NT text on the man of sin / son of perdition / the "Wicked one" whom Christ will destroy at His coming. Together with 1 Thessalonians, it forms the earliest extensive NT teaching on the second coming. It also gives the most concrete NT principle for church-level economic ethics: "If any would not work, neither should he eat." Both halves of the letter — the prophecy of the man of sin and the command to work — flow from the same pastoral concern: the day of Christ has not yet come, so the church must keep its

feet on the ground and its hands at the plow.

Chapter 1

Paul gives thanks for the growing faith and love of the Thessalonians amid persecution, and assures them that God will repay with tribulation those who trouble them. He declares that the Lord Jesus will be revealed from heaven with His mighty angels in flaming fire, taking vengeance on those who do not know God and do not obey the gospel.

- 1
- Paul, and Silvanus, and Timotheus, unto the church of the Thessalonians in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:*

From Paul, and Silas, and Timothy — to the church of the Thessalonians in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Silvanus** (sil-VAY-nus), also called **Silas** (SY-las) — A leading man among the brethren at Jerusalem (Acts 15:22) and Paul's chief companion on the second missionary journey (Acts 15:40 onward). The Modern column uses the shorter, more common name "Silas," which is how he is named in Acts; "Silvanus" is the Latin form used by Paul in his letters.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Timotheus** (tih-MOH-thee-us), better known as **Timothy** (TIM-uh-thee) — Paul's young protégé from Lystra; the son of a Greek father and a believing Jewish mother (Acts 16:1). The Modern column uses the universally known Anglicized form "Timothy." Paul calls him "my own son in the faith" (1 Tim 1:2) and writes him two of the Pastoral Epistles.

- 2
- Grace unto you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.*

Grace and peace to You from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

- 3
- We are bound to thank God always for you, brethren, as it is meet, because that your faith groweth exceedingly, and the charity of every one of you all toward each other aboundeth;*

We are bound to thank God always for You, brethren, as it is fitting, because Your faith is growing greatly, and the charity of every one of you toward each other is increasing.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — Love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

- 4 *So that we ourselves glory in you in the churches of God for your patience and faith in all your persecutions and tribulations that ye endure:* So we ourselves boast about You among the churches of God — about Your patience and Your faith in all the persecutions and tribulations that You endure.
- 5 *Which is a manifest token of the righteous judgment of God, that ye may be counted worthy of the kingdom of God, for which ye also suffer:* This is a clear sign of the righteous judgment of God — that You may be counted worthy of the kingdom of God, for which You are also suffering.
- 6 *Seeing it is a righteous thing with God to recompense tribulation to them that trouble you;* For it is a righteous thing with God to repay with tribulation those who trouble You,
- 7 *And to you who are troubled rest with us, when the Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven with his mighty angels,* and to give You who are troubled rest with us, when the Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven with His mighty angels,
- 8 *In flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God, and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ:* in flaming fire, taking vengeance on those who do not know God, and who do not obey the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 9 *Who shall be punished with everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord, and from the glory of his power;* They shall be punished with everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord, and from the glory of His power,
- 10 *When he shall come to be glorified in his saints, and to be admired in all them that believe (because our testimony among you was believed) in that day.* when He shall come to be glorified in His saints, and to be admired by all those who believe — because our testimony among You was believed — in that day.

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| <p>11 <i>Wherefore also we pray always for you, that our God would count you worthy of this calling, and fulfil all the good pleasure of his goodness, and the work of faith with power:</i></p> <p>12 <i>That the name of our Lord Jesus Christ may be glorified in you, and ye in him, according to the grace of our God and the Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> | <p>Therefore we also pray always for You, that our God would count You worthy of this calling, and would fulfill in You every good pleasure of His goodness and the work of faith with power,</p> <p>so that the name of our Lord Jesus Christ may be glorified in You, and You in Him, according to the grace of our God and the Lord Jesus Christ.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — Rom 1:7
- v3 — 2 Pet 3:18; 2 Pet 1:5-10; Isa 40:29-31; Prov 4:18; Phil 1:9
- v4 — Heb 10:36; Jas 5:7-8; Heb 12:1-3; 2 Cor 7:14; 1 Thess 2:14
- v5 — Phil 1:28; Acts 14:22
- v6 — Col 3:25; Zech 2:8; Ps 94:20-23; Deut 32:41-43; Rev 6:10
- v7 — Rev 14:13; Matt 16:27; Jude 1:14-15; Rev 22:16
- v8 — 1 Pet 4:17; 2 Pet 3:7; Heb 10:27; Heb 10:30; 2 Pet 3:10-12
- v9 — Matt 25:41; Rev 14:10-11; Matt 25:46; 2 Thess 2:8; Rev 21:8
- v10 — Eph 1:18; 2 Tim 4:8; John 17:10; 1 Cor 3:13; Isa 49:3
- v11 — Phil 2:13; Col 1:9-13; 1 Thess 1:3; 1 Thess 3:9-13; 2 Thess 2:14
- v12 — 2 Thess 1:10; 1 Pet 4:14; John 17:10; 2 Cor 13:4

Chapter 2

Paul urges the Thessalonians not to be troubled by claims that the day of Christ has already come, for that day will not come unless there is a falling away first and the man of sin is revealed, the son of perdition, who exalts himself above all that is called God. He reminds them that the mystery of iniquity is already at work, but the Lord shall consume the wicked one with the spirit of His mouth at His coming.

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| <p>1 <i>Now we beseech you, brethren, by the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, and by our gathering together unto him,</i></p> | <p>Now we appeal to You, brethren, regarding the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, and our being gathered together to Him:</p> |
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- 2

That ye be not soon shaken in mind, or be troubled, neither by spirit, nor by word, nor by letter as from us, as that the day of Christ is at hand.

do not be quickly shaken in mind or troubled — not by any spirit, nor by any word, nor by any letter supposedly from us — claiming that the day of Christ has already come.
- 3

Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

Let no man deceive You by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition —

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Perdition** (per-DISH-un) — *Eternal ruin and destruction; the final, conscious loss of all things in the judgment of God. "The son of perdition" is a Hebrew-style title meaning "the one who belongs to perdition, who is destined for it." Christ uses the same phrase of Judas in John 17:12.*

■ **WORD NOTE** — **That man of sin / the son of perdition** — *A specific, future, individual figure prophesied here by Paul. He is the same person John calls "the antichrist" (1 John 2:18; 4:3) and "the beast" (Revelation 13). He will oppose and exalt himself above every god, sit in the temple of God, and proclaim himself to be God (v4). His coming is empowered by Satan, with all power, signs, and lying wonders (v9). He is destroyed by Christ at His second coming (v8). The KJV does NOT call him "the man of lawlessness" (which is the NIV/ESV reading from a different Greek text); the Textus Receptus reads "the man of sin," and the Modern column preserves that.*

- 4

Who opposeth and exalteth himself above all that is called God, or that is worshipped; so that he as God sitteth in the temple of God, shewing himself that he is God.

He opposes and exalts Himself above all that is called God, or that is worshipped — so that He, as God, sits in the temple of God, showing Himself that He is God.
- 5

Remember ye not, that, when I was yet with you, I told you these things?

Do You not remember that when I was still with You, I told You these things?
- 6

And now ye know what withholdeth that he might be revealed in his time.

And now You know what is holding Him back, so that He may be revealed in His own time.
- 7

For the mystery of iniquity doth already work: only he who now letteth will let, until he be taken out of the way.

For the mystery of iniquity is already at work; only He who now restrains will restrain, until he be taken out of the way.

■ **WORD NOTE** — ***Iniquity** (in-ik-wih-tee) — Deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. The "mystery of iniquity" is the hidden working of lawlessness in the world, already at work in Paul's day, which will one day come into the open in the person of the man of sin.*

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| <p>8 <i>And then shall that Wicked be revealed, whom the Lord shall consume with the spirit of his mouth, and shall destroy with the brightness of his coming:</i></p> <p>9 <i>Even him, whose coming is after the working of Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders,</i></p> <p>10 <i>And with all deceivableness of unrighteousness in them that perish; because they received not the love of the truth, that they might be saved.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And for this cause God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie:</i></p> <p>12 <i>That they all might be damned who believed not the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness.</i></p> <p>13 <i>But we are bound to give thanks alway to God for you, brethren beloved of the Lord, because God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief of the truth:</i></p> | <p>And then shall that Wicked one be revealed, whom the Lord shall consume with the spirit of His mouth, and shall destroy with the brightness of His coming —</p> <p>the one whose coming is according to the working of Satan, with all power and signs and lying wonders,</p> <p>and with all the deception of unrighteousness in those who perish, because they did not receive the love of the truth, that they might be saved.</p> <p>For this cause God shall send them strong delusion, so that they will believe the lie,</p> <p>so that they all may be damned who did not believe the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness.</p> <p>But we are bound to give thanks always to God for You, brethren beloved of the Lord, because God has from the beginning chosen You to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief of the truth —</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — ***Sanctification** (SANK-tih-fih-KAY-shun) — Being made holy; the lifelong process of being set apart for God. Sanctification is the Spirit's work in the believer, gradually making us more and more like Christ, until the work is completed at His coming.*

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| <p>14 <i>Whereunto he called you by our gospel, to the obtaining of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> | <p>to which He called You by our gospel, for the obtaining of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.</p> |
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| 15 | <i>Therefore, brethren, stand fast, and hold the traditions which ye have been taught, whether by word, or our epistle.</i> | Therefore, brethren, stand fast, and hold to the traditions which You have been taught, whether by word or by our letter. |
| 16 | <i>Now our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God, even our Father, which hath loved us, and hath given us everlasting consolation and good hope through grace,</i> | Now may our Lord Jesus Christ Himself, and God our Father, who has loved us and given us everlasting consolation and good hope through grace, |
| 17 | <i>Comfort your hearts, and stablish you in every good word and work.</i> | comfort Your hearts, and establish You in every good word and work. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 John 4:1-2; Mark 13:7; Matt 24:4-6; 2 Pet 3:4-8; 2 Thess 3:17
v3 — Matt 24:4-6; 1 John 2:18; Eph 5:6; 2 Thess 2:8-10; 1 Tim 4:1-3
v4 — Ezek 28:2; Dan 7:25; Isa 14:13-14; Rev 13:6-7; Ezek 28:6
v8 — 2 Thess 2:3; Rev 19:20-21; Isa 11:4; Rev 20:10; Rev 19:15
v9 — Matt 24:24; Rev 19:20; Eph 2:2; 2 Cor 11:3; John 4:48
v10 — 1 Cor 1:18; Prov 1:7; 2 Cor 4:2-3; John 8:45-47; 2 Pet 2:12
v11 — Rom 1:28; John 12:39-43; 1 Tim 4:1; Matt 24:11; Ps 81:11-12
v13 — 2 Tim 1:9; Eph 1:4-5; 1 Thess 1:4; 1 Thess 5:9; Rom 9:11
v14 — 1 Thess 2:12; 1 Pet 5:10; Rom 8:17; 1 Thess 1:5
v15 — 1 Cor 11:2; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Thess 2:2; 1 Cor 16:13; Phil 4:1
v16 — John 3:16; Rom 5:2-5; 1 Pet 1:3-8; Titus 3:4-7
v17 — 2 Thess 3:3; 1 Thess 3:13; 1 Thess 3:2; 1 Cor 1:8; Col 2:7

Chapter 3

Paul asks for prayer that the word of the Lord may spread freely and commands the church to withdraw from every brother who walks disorderly. He reminds them that he worked night and day so as not to be a burden, and declares that if any man will not work, neither should he eat.

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| 1 | <i>Finally, brethren, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may have free course, and be glorified, even as it is with you:</i> | Finally, brethren, pray for us — that the word of the Lord may run freely and be glorified, even as it is with you, |
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| 2 <i>And that we may be delivered from unreasonable and wicked men: for all men have not faith.</i> | and that we may be delivered from unreasonable and wicked men; for not all men have faith. |
| 3 <i>But the Lord is faithful, who shall establish you, and keep you from evil.</i> | But the Lord is faithful; He will establish you and keep you from evil. |
| 4 <i>And we have confidence in the Lord touching you, that ye both do and will do the things which we command you.</i> | And we have confidence in the Lord concerning you, that you both do and will do the things which we command you. |
| 5 <i>And the Lord direct your hearts into the love of God, and into the patient waiting for Christ.</i> | May the Lord direct Your hearts into the love of God, and into the patient waiting for Christ. |
| 6 <i>Now we command you, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye withdraw yourselves from every brother that walketh disorderly, and not after the tradition which he received of us.</i> | Now we command You, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ: withdraw yourselves from every brother who walks disorderly, and not according to the tradition which He received from us. |
| 7 <i>For yourselves know how ye ought to follow us: for we behaved not ourselves disorderly among you;</i> | For You yourselves know how You ought to follow our example, for we did not behave ourselves disorderly among You, |
| 8 <i>Neither did we eat any man's bread for nought; but wrought with labour and travail night and day, that we might not be chargeable to any of you:</i> | nor did we eat any man's bread without paying for it; instead we worked with labor and toil night and day, so that we would not be a burden to any of You. |
| 9 <i>Not because we have not power, but to make ourselves an ensample unto you to follow us.</i> | Not because we did not have the right, but to make ourselves an example for You to follow. |
| 10 <i>For even when we were with you, this we commanded you, that if any would not work, neither should he eat.</i> | For even when we were with You, this we commanded You: if any would not work, neither should He eat. |

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| 11 | <i>For we hear that there are some which walk among you disorderly, working not at all, but are busybodies.</i> | For we hear that there are some who walk among You disorderly — not working at all, but busybodies. |
| 12 | <i>Now them that are such we command and exhort by our Lord Jesus Christ, that with quietness they work, and eat their own bread.</i> | Now those who are such we command and exhort by our Lord Jesus Christ — work quietly, and eat Your own bread. |
| 13 | <i>But ye, brethren, be not weary in well doing.</i> | But You, brethren, do not grow weary in well doing. |
| 14 | <i>And if any man obey not our word by this epistle, note that man, and have no company with him, that he may be ashamed.</i> | And if any man does not obey our word in this letter, take note of that man, and have no company with him, so that he may be ashamed. |
| 15 | <i>Yet count him not as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.</i> | Yet do not count Him as an enemy, but admonish Him as a brother. |
| 16 | <i>Now the Lord of peace himself give you peace always by all means. The Lord be with you all.</i> | Now may the Lord of peace Himself give You peace always, by every means. The Lord be with you all. |
| 17 | <i>The salutation of Paul with mine own hand, which is the token in every epistle: so I write.</i> | The greeting is from Paul, by my own hand, which is the sign in every epistle of mine — this is how I write. |
| 18 | <i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.</i> | The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Thess 5:25; Col 4:3; Eph 6:19-20; Acts 19:20; 1 Cor 16:9
v3 — 2 Tim 4:18; 1 Thess 5:24; 1 Cor 10:13; Ps 121:7; 1 Cor 1:9
v5 — Ps 119:36; 1 Chr 29:18; Deut 30:6; 1 John 4:19; Rev 3:10-11
v6 — 2 Thess 3:10-11; 2 Thess 3:7; Col 3:17; Rom 16:17; 1 Thess 5:14
v7 — 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Thess 3:9; 1 Cor 4:16; 1 Cor 11:1; 1 Thess 1:6-7
v8 — Matt 6:11; 1 Thess 2:9; Eph 4:28; Acts 18:3; 1 Thess 4:11
v9 — 2 Thess 3:7; 1 Cor 9:4-14; 1 Thess 2:6
v10 — Gen 3:19; 1 Thess 4:11; Prov 13:4; Prov 20:4; Prov 21:25
v11 — 1 Tim 5:13; 2 Thess 3:6; 1 Thess 4:11; 1 Pet 4:15

v13 — Gal 6:9-10; Heb 12:3; 2 Cor 4:1; Isa 40:29-31; 2 Cor 4:16

v14 — Titus 3:10; 1 Cor 5:11; 2 Thess 3:6; Ps 83:16; 1 Thess 4:8

v16 — Ps 29:11; John 16:33; Matt 1:23; John 14:27; Judg 6:24

1 Timothy

Author: Paul the apostle — one of the three "Pastoral Epistles" (1 Timothy, 2 Timothy, Titus) addressed to individual church leaders rather than congregations.

Date written: c. AD 62–64, after Paul's release from his first Roman imprisonment, during a period of further travel not recorded in Acts.

Written to: Timothy, Paul's "own son in the faith" (1:2), who had been left in charge of the church at Ephesus.

Setting: Paul has left Timothy in Ephesus to deal with false teachers, maintain sound doctrine, and establish proper church order. Timothy is young, apparently somewhat timid, and facing serious opposition. Paul writes to strengthen him and give him a clear mandate.

Where this sits historically: Written under Nero between Paul's two Roman imprisonments, after the apostle's release from house arrest around AD 62 and before Nero's persecution of Christians following the Great Fire of AD 64.

Contemporaries: Timothy ministered at Ephesus, Titus on Crete, and the second wave of Pauline letters (2 Timothy and Titus) followed soon after; Peter was likely already in Rome writing 1 Peter.

Big themes:

- Sound doctrine — false teachers are promoting "fables and endless genealogies" and speculative arguments; Paul repeatedly urges Timothy to hold fast to the "faithful saying" and the apostolic deposit
- Church order — 1 Timothy contains the NT's most detailed instructions for church leadership: qualifications for bishops (overseers) and deacons, instructions on prayer, and guidelines for widows
- "God was manifest in the flesh" — 3:16 is one of the great Christological confessions of the NT; the TR reading ("God was manifest in the flesh," not "He who was manifest") makes an explicit claim for the incarnation
- The role of women in the assembly — 2:11–15 addresses the ordering of public worship; the passage has been extensively discussed throughout church history
- Money and godliness — "the love of money is the root of all evil" (6:10); the rich are warned, and contentment with godliness is commended as "great gain"

Key passages: 1 Tim 1:15; 2:5; 3:16; 4:16; 6:10

How it fits: 1 Timothy is the NT's foundational manual for church leadership. Its qualifications for elders and deacons have governed church governance for two millennia. Written between Paul's two Roman imprisonments, it gives an inside view of the pastoral challenges the early church faced as it matured beyond its founding generation.

Chapter 1

Paul charges Timothy to remain at Ephesus and command certain men not to teach false doctrines or give heed to fables and endless genealogies. He declares that the law is good if used lawfully, gives thanks for his own calling despite being formerly a blasphemer and persecutor, and calls himself the chief of sinners whom Christ Jesus saved as a pattern for all who would believe.

- 1

Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the commandment of God our Saviour, and Lord Jesus Christ, which is our hope;
- Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the command of God our Savior and of Christ Jesus our hope,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. Mercy is God withholding the wrath we have earned. Grace gives us what we don't deserve; mercy spares us from what we do deserve. Both flow from God's heart toward sinners.

- 2

Unto Timothy, my own son in the faith: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God our Father and Jesus Christ our Lord.
- To Timothy, my true son in the faith: grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 3

As I besought thee to abide still at Ephesus, when I went into Macedonia, that thou mightest charge some that they teach no other doctrine,
- As I urged You when I went into Macedonia, stay there in Ephesus so that You may command certain people not to teach false doctrines
- 4

Neither give heed to fables and endless genealogies, which minister questions, rather than godly edifying which is in faith: so do.
- or give heed to fables and endless genealogies, which produce questions rather than godly edifying which is in faith. So do.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

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| 5 <i>Now the end of the commandment is charity out of a pure heart, and of a good conscience, and of faith unfeigned:</i> | The goal of this instruction is charity out of a pure heart and a good conscience and sincere faith. |
| 6 <i>From which some having swerved have turned aside unto vain jangling;</i> | Some have swerved from these and have turned aside to vain jangling. |
| 7 <i>Desiring to be teachers of the law; understanding neither what they say, nor whereof they affirm.</i> | They want to be teachers of the law, but they do not know what they are talking about or what they so confidently affirm. |
| 8 <i>But we know that the law is good, if a man use it lawfully;</i> | We know that the law is good if one uses it properly. |
| 9 <i>Knowing this, that the law is not made for a righteous man, but for the lawless and disobedient, for the ungodly and for sinners, for unholy and profane, for murderers of fathers and murderers of mothers, for manslayers,</i> | We also know that the law is made not for the righteous but for lawbreakers and rebels, the ungodly and sinful, the unholy and irreligious, for those who kill their fathers or mothers, for murderers, |
| 10 <i>For whoremongers, for them that defile themselves with mankind, for menstealers, for liars, for perjured persons, and if there be any other thing that is contrary to sound doctrine;</i> | for the sexually immoral, for those practicing homosexuality, for slave traders and liars and perjurers — and for whatever else is contrary to the sound doctrine |
| 11 <i>According to the glorious gospel of the blessed God, which was committed to my trust.</i> | that conforms to the gospel concerning the glory of the blessed God, which He entrusted to me. |
| 12 <i>And I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who hath enabled me, for that he counted me faithful, putting me into the ministry;</i> | I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who has given me strength, that He considered me trustworthy, appointing me to His service. |

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| 13 <i>Who was before a blasphemer, and a persecutor, and injurious: but I obtained mercy, because I did it ignorantly in unbelief.</i> | Even though I was once a blasphemer and a persecutor and a violent man, I was shown mercy because I acted in ignorance and unbelief. |
| 14 <i>And the grace of our Lord was exceeding abundant with faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.</i> | The grace of our Lord was poured out on me abundantly, along with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus. |
| 15 <i>This is a faithful saying, and worthy of all acceptation, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners; of whom I am chief.</i> | Here is a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners — of whom I am the worst. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — *patient endurance with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. Longsuffering is not weakness — it is strength held back. God is longsuffering toward sinners, bearing with them rather than judging immediately.*

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| 16 <i>Howbeit for this cause I obtained mercy, that in me first Jesus Christ might shew forth all longsuffering, for a pattern to them which should hereafter believe on him to life everlasting.</i> | But for that very reason I was shown mercy so that in me, the worst of sinners, Christ Jesus might display His immense longsuffering as an example for those who would believe in Him and receive eternal life. |
| 17 <i>Now unto the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only wise God, be honour and glory for ever and ever. Amen.</i> | Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only wise God, be honor and glory forever and ever. Amen. |
| 18 <i>This charge I commit unto thee, son Timothy, according to the prophecies which went before on thee, that thou by them mightest war a good warfare;</i> | Timothy, my son, I am giving you this command in keeping with the prophecies once made about you, so that by recalling them you may fight the battle well, |
| 19 <i>Holding faith, and a good conscience; which some having put away concerning faith have made shipwreck:</i> | holding on to faith and a good conscience, which some have rejected and so have suffered shipwreck with regard to the faith. |

- 20 *Of whom is Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.*
- Among them are Hymenaeus and Alexander, whom I have handed over to Satan to be taught not to blaspheme.

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Macedonia (*mas-eh-DO-nee-ah*) — A region of northern Greece — Paul received a vision of a man from Macedonia calling for help; he brought the gospel to Europe through cities like Philippi and Thessalonica.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Titus 1:3; Col 1:27; Acts 9:15; Jude 1:25; Gal 1:1
- v2 — Titus 1:4; 2 Tim 1:2; 1 Cor 4:14-17; Phil 2:19-22; Acts 16:1-3
- v4 — Titus 1:14; 1 Tim 4:7; Titus 3:9; 2 Tim 4:4; 2 Pet 1:16
- v5 — 1 Tim 1:19; Gal 5:22; Gal 5:13-14; 2 Tim 2:22; 2 Tim 1:5
- v6 — Titus 1:10; 2 Tim 2:23-24; 1 Tim 6:20-21; Titus 3:9; 1 Tim 5:15
- v9 — Gal 3:19; 1 Pet 4:18; Rom 5:20; Gal 3:10-14; Gal 5:23
- v10 — 1 Cor 6:9-10; Lev 18:22; 2 Tim 4:3; Rom 1:26; Gal 5:19-21
- v12 — Phil 4:13; 2 Tim 4:17; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Col 1:25; Phil 2:11
- v14 — 2 Tim 1:13; Eph 1:7-8; 1 Cor 15:10; 1 Pet 1:3; Isa 55:6-7
- v15 — Mark 2:17; Luke 19:10; John 3:16-17; John 12:47; John 1:12
- v17 — Eph 3:20-21; Jude 1:25; 1 Tim 6:15-16; Rev 17:14; Rev 19:1
- v18 — 1 Tim 4:14; 2 Tim 4:1-3; 1 Tim 6:20; 2 Tim 2:1-5; 2 Cor 10:3-4

Chapter 2

Paul urges that prayers be made for all men, especially kings and those in authority, so that believers may lead quiet and peaceable lives. He declares that there is one God and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself a ransom for all.

- 1 *I exhort therefore, that, first of all, supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men;*
- I urge, then, first of all, that petitions, prayers, intercession, and thanksgiving be made for all people—

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| 2 <i>For kings, and for all that are in authority; that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty.</i> | for kings and all those in authority, that we may live peaceful and quiet lives in all godliness and holiness. |
| 3 <i>For this is good and acceptable in the sight of God our Saviour;</i> | This is good, and pleases God our Savior, |
| 4 <i>Who will have all men to be saved, and to come unto the knowledge of the truth.</i> | who wants all people to be saved and to come to a knowledge of the truth. |
| 5 <i>For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus;</i> | For there is one God and one mediator between God and mankind, the man Christ Jesus, |
| 6 <i>Who gave himself a ransom for all, to be testified in due time.</i> | who gave Himself as a ransom for all people. This has now been witnessed to at the proper time. |
| 7 <i>Whereunto I am ordained a preacher, and an apostle, (I speak the truth in Christ, and lie not;) a teacher of the Gentiles in faith and verity.</i> | And for this purpose I was appointed a herald and an apostle — I am telling the truth, I am not lying — and a true and faithful teacher of the Gentiles. |
| 8 <i>I will therefore that men pray every where, lifting up holy hands, without wrath and doubting.</i> | Therefore I want the men everywhere to pray, lifting up holy hands without anger or disputing. |
| 9 <i>In like manner also, that women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with broided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array;</i> | In like manner also, that women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with braided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly clothing, |
| 10 <i>But (which becometh women professing godliness) with good works.</i> | but with good deeds, appropriate for women who profess to worship God. |
| 11 <i>Let the woman learn in silence with all subjection.</i> | A woman should learn in quietness and full submission. |

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| 12 | <i>But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence.</i> | I do not permit a woman to teach or to assume authority over a man; she must be quiet. |
| 13 | <i>For Adam was first formed, then Eve.</i> | For Adam was formed first, then Eve. |
| 14 | <i>And Adam was not deceived, but the woman being deceived was in the transgression.</i> | And Adam was not the one deceived; it was the woman who was deceived and became a sinner. |
| 15 | <i>Notwithstanding she shall be saved in childbearing, if they continue in faith and charity and holiness with sobriety.</i> | But women will be saved through childbearing — if they continue in faith, charity, and holiness with propriety. |

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Adam (*AD-um*) — The first man, formed from the dust of the earth — his name in Hebrew means 'man' or 'from the ground (adamah).'

Eve (*EEV*) — The first woman, made from Adam's rib — her name in Hebrew means 'living' or 'life-giver,' because she is the mother of all living.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Thess 1:3; Matt 6:9-10; Jas 5:16; Ps 67:1-4; Eph 5:20
- v2 — 1 Pet 2:9-13; Jer 29:7; Ezra 6:10; Rom 13:1-7; Prov 24:21
- v4 — Ezek 18:32; 2 Pet 3:9; Ezek 18:23; Titus 2:11; John 3:15-17
- v5 — 1 Cor 8:6; Gal 3:20; Heb 9:15; Heb 7:25; Deut 6:4
- v6 — Matt 20:28; 1 Pet 3:18; 1 John 2:1-2; Gal 4:4; Rev 1:5
- v7 — Acts 9:15; 2 Tim 1:11; Rom 9:1; Eph 3:7-8; Rom 15:16
- v8 — Ps 134:2; Ps 63:4; Heb 10:22; Titus 3:8; Luke 24:50
- v9 — 1 Pet 3:3-5; Titus 2:3-5; Ps 149:4; Jer 4:30; 2 Kgs 9:30
- v11 — 1 Cor 14:34-35; Eph 5:22-24; 1 Cor 11:3; Col 3:18; 1 Pet 3:5-6
- v12 — 1 Cor 14:34
- v13 — Gen 2:18; 1 Cor 11:8-9; Gen 2:22; Gen 1:27; Gen 2:7
- v14 — 2 Cor 11:3; Gen 3:6; Gen 3:12-13

Chapter 3

Paul sets forth the qualifications for bishops and deacons, requiring them to be blameless, sober, hospitable, and able to rule their own houses well. He writes so that Timothy may know how to conduct himself in the house of God, and declares the great mystery of godliness: God

was manifest in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached to the Gentiles, believed on in the world, and received up into glory.

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| <p>1 <i>This is a true saying, If a man desire the office of a bishop, he desireth a good work.</i></p> | Here is a trustworthy saying: Whoever aspires to be an overseer desires a noble task. |
| <p>2 <i>A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;</i></p> | Now the overseer is to be above reproach, faithful to his wife, temperate, self-controlled, respectable, hospitable, able to teach, |
| <p>3 <i>Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;</i></p> | not given to drunkenness, not violent but gentle, not quarrelsome, not a lover of money. |
| <p>4 <i>One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all gravity;</i></p> | He must manage His own family well and see that His children obey Him, and He must do so in a manner worthy of full respect. |
| <p>5 <i>(For if a man know not how to rule his own house, how shall he take care of the church of God?)</i></p> | If anyone does not know how to manage his own family, how can He take care of God's church? |
| <p>6 <i>Not a novice, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.</i></p> | He must not be a recent convert, or he may become conceited and fall under the same judgment as the devil. |
| <p>7 <i>Moreover he must have a good report of them which are without; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.</i></p> | He must also have a good reputation with outsiders, so that he will not fall into disgrace and into the devil's trap. |
| <p>8 <i>Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;</i></p> | In the same way, deacons are to be worthy of respect, sincere, not indulging in too much wine, and not pursuing dishonest gain. |
| <p>9 <i>Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience.</i></p> | They must keep hold of the deep truths of the faith with a clear conscience. |

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| 10 | <i>And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found blameless.</i> | They must first be tested; and then if there is nothing against them, let them serve as deacons. |
| 11 | <i>Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.</i> | In the same way, the women are to be worthy of respect, not malicious talkers but temperate and trustworthy in everything. |
| 12 | <i>Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well.</i> | A deacon must be faithful to his wife and must manage his children and his household well. |
| 13 | <i>For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.</i> | Those who have served well gain an excellent standing and great assurance in their faith in Christ Jesus. |
| 14 | <i>These things write I unto thee, hoping to come unto thee shortly:</i> | Although I hope to come to You soon, I am writing You these instructions |
| 15 | <i>But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.</i> | so that, if I am delayed, You will know how people ought to conduct themselves in God's household, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and foundation of the truth. |
| 16 | <i>And without controversy great is the mystery of godliness: God was manifest in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached unto the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up into glory.</i> | Beyond all question, the mystery from which true godliness springs is great: God was manifest in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached to the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up into glory. |

Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Cross-References:

v1 — Titus 1:7; Acts 20:28; 1 Pet 5:2; 1 Pet 2:25; Jas 5:19-20

v2 — 2 Tim 2:24; Titus 1:6-9; Rom 12:13; 1 Tim 5:9; 1 Tim 3:10-11

v3 — Titus 1:7; Titus 3:2; Eph 5:18

v4 — Titus 1:6; Gen 18:19; 1 Tim 3:12; Titus 2:2
v6 — 1 Tim 6:4; Heb 5:12-13
v7 — 2 Cor 8:21; Col 4:5; 2 Tim 2:26
v8 — Phil 1:1; Titus 2:3; 1 Tim 5:23; 1 Tim 3:3; Acts 6:3-6
v9 — 1 Tim 1:19; 2 John 1:9-10
v11 — Titus 2:3; Titus 3:2; 1 Tim 3:2
v12 — 1 Tim 3:2; 1 Tim 3:4-5
v15 — 1 Pet 2:5; Eph 2:21-22; 1 Kgs 2:4; Matt 16:18-19; 1 Thess 1:9
v16 — John 1:14; Heb 1:3; Mark 16:19; Rom 16:25; 1 John 5:6-8

Chapter 4

Paul warns that in the latter times some shall depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits and doctrines of devils, forbidding to marry and commanding to abstain from foods which God created to be received with thanksgiving. He charges Timothy to be an example to the believers in word, in conduct, in charity, in spirit, in faith, and in purity, and not to neglect the gift that is in him.

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| 1 <i>Now the Spirit speaketh expressly, that in the latter times some shall depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits, and doctrines of devils;</i> | The Spirit clearly says that in later times some will depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits and doctrines of devils, |
| 2 <i>Speaking lies in hypocrisy; having their conscience seared with a hot iron;</i> | Such teachings come through hypocritical liars, whose consciences have been seared as with a hot iron. |
| 3 <i>Forbidding to marry, and commanding to abstain from meats, which God hath created to be received with thanksgiving of them which believe and know the truth.</i> | They forbid people to marry and order them to abstain from certain foods, which God created to be received with thanksgiving by those who believe and who know the truth. |
| 4 <i>For every creature of God is good, and nothing to be refused, if it be received with thanksgiving:</i> | For everything God created is good, and nothing is to be rejected if it is received with thanksgiving, |
| 5 <i>For it is sanctified by the word of God and prayer.</i> | because it is consecrated by the word of God and prayer. |

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| 6 | <i>If thou put the brethren in remembrance of these things, thou shalt be a good minister of Jesus Christ, nourished up in the words of faith and of good doctrine, whereunto thou hast attained.</i> | If You point these things out to the brothers and sisters, You will be a good minister of Christ Jesus, nourished on the truths of the faith and of the good teaching that You have followed. |
| 7 | <i>But refuse profane and old wives' fables, and exercise thyself rather unto godliness.</i> | Have nothing to do with godless myths and old wives' tales; rather, train Yourself to be godly. |
| 8 | <i>For bodily exercise profiteth little: but godliness is profitable unto all things, having promise of the life that now is, and of that which is to come.</i> | For physical training is of some value, but godliness has value for all things, holding promise for both the present life and the life to come. |
| 9 | <i>This is a faithful saying and worthy of all acceptance.</i> | This is a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance. |
| 10 | <i>For therefore we both labour and suffer reproach, because we trust in the living God, who is the Saviour of all men, specially of those that believe.</i> | For this reason we both labor and suffer reproach, because we trust in the living God, Who is the Savior of all people, especially of those who believe. |
| 11 | <i>These things command and teach.</i> | Command and teach these things. |
| 12 | <i>Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity.</i> | Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in charity, in faith, and in purity. |
| 13 | <i>Till I come, give attendance to reading, to exhortation, to doctrine.</i> | Until I come, devote Yourself to the public reading of Scripture, to preaching, and to teaching. |
| 14 | <i>Neglect not the gift that is in thee, which was given thee by prophecy, with the laying on of the hands of the presbytery.</i> | Do not neglect Your gift, which was given You through prophecy when the body of elders laid their hands on You. |

15	<i>Meditate upon these things; give thyself wholly to them; that thy profiting may appear to all.</i>	Be diligent in these matters; give Yourself wholly to them, so that everyone may see Your progress.
16	<i>Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee.</i>	Watch Your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if You do, You will save both Yourself and Your hearers.

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Tim 3:1-9; 2 Pet 2:1; 2 Cor 11:13-15; Jude 1:18; 2 Thess 2:3-12
- v2 — Eph 4:19; Rom 16:18; Acts 20:30; 2 Pet 2:1-3; Matt 24:24
- v3 — 1 Tim 4:4; Heb 13:4; Rom 14:6; Gen 9:3; 1 Cor 10:30-31
- v4 — Rom 14:20; 1 Cor 10:25; Rom 14:14; 1 Cor 10:23; Acts 21:25
- v7 — 2 Tim 2:16; Titus 2:12; 1 Tim 1:4; 2 Pet 1:5-8; Titus 3:9
- v8 — Matt 6:33; 1 Tim 6:6; Ps 37:3-4; Prov 22:4; Prov 19:23
- v10 — 1 Tim 2:4; 1 John 2:2; 1 Tim 2:6; John 1:29; 1 John 4:14
- v12 — Titus 2:7; 2 Tim 2:22; 2 Tim 2:15; 1 Pet 5:3; 2 Pet 1:5-8
- v13 — Acts 6:4; Titus 2:15; 1 Tim 4:16; 2 Tim 4:2; 2 Tim 2:15-17
- v14 — 2 Tim 1:6; 1 Pet 4:9-11; 1 Tim 1:18; Acts 6:6; 1 Tim 5:22
- v15 — Matt 5:16; Ps 143:5; Phil 2:15-16; Ps 104:34; Acts 6:4
- v16 — Titus 1:9; Titus 2:7; 2 John 1:8-9; 1 Cor 3:10-11; Ezek 33:7-9

Chapter 5

Paul gives instructions on how to treat elders, widows, and various members of the church, teaching that the church should honor true widows and that those with families should care for their own. He instructs that elders who rule well should be counted worthy of double honour, especially those who labour in the word and doctrine.

1	<i>Rebuke not an elder, but intreat him as a father; and the younger men as brethren;</i>	Do not rebuke an older man harshly, but appeal to him as if he were your father. Treat younger men as brothers,
2	<i>The elder women as mothers; the younger as sisters, with all purity.</i>	older women as mothers, and younger women as sisters, with absolute purity.

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| 3 <i>Honour widows that are widows indeed.</i> | Give proper recognition to those widows who are really in need. |
| 4 <i>But if any widow have children or nephews, let them learn first to shew piety at home, and to requite their parents: for that is good and acceptable before God.</i> | But if a widow has children or grandchildren, these should learn first of all to put their religion into practice by caring for their own family and so repaying their parents and grandparents, for this is pleasing to God. |
| 5 <i>Now she that is a widow indeed, and desolate, trusteth in God, and continueth in supplications and prayers night and day.</i> | The widow who is really in need and left all alone puts her hope in God and continues night and day to pray and to ask God for help. |
| 6 <i>But she that liveth in pleasure is dead while she liveth.</i> | But the widow who lives for pleasure is dead even while she lives. |
| 7 <i>And these things give in charge, that they may be blameless.</i> | Give the people these instructions, so that no one may be open to blame. |
| 8 <i>But if any provide not for his own, and specially for those of his own house, he hath denied the faith, and is worse than an infidel.</i> | Anyone who does not provide for their relatives, and especially for their own household, has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever. |
| 9 <i>Let not a widow be taken into the number under threescore years old, having been the wife of one man,</i> | No widow may be put on the list of widows unless she is over sixty, has been faithful to her husband, |
| 10 <i>Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children, if she have lodged strangers, if she have washed the saints' feet, if she have relieved the afflicted, if she have diligently followed every good work.</i> | and is well known for her good deeds, such as bringing up children, showing hospitality, washing the feet of the Lord's people, helping those in trouble, and devoting herself to all kinds of good deeds. |

- 11 *But the younger widows refuse: for when they have begun to wax wanton against Christ, they will marry;* As for younger widows, do not put them on such a list. For when their sensual desires overcome their dedication to Christ, they want to marry.
- 12 *Having damnation, because they have cast off their first faith.* Thus they bring judgment on themselves, because they have broken their first pledge.
- 13 *And withal they learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house; and not only idle, but tattlers also and busybodies, speaking things which they ought not.* And besides, they learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house; and not only idle, but tattlers also and busybodies, speaking things which they ought not.
- 14 *I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully.* So I counsel younger widows to marry, to have children, to manage their homes and to give the enemy no opportunity for slander.
- 15 *For some are already turned aside after Satan.* Some have in fact already turned away to follow Satan.
- 16 *If any man or woman that believeth have widows, let them relieve them, and let not the church be charged; that it may relieve them that are widows indeed.* If any woman who is a believer has widows in her care, she should continue to help them and not let the church be burdened with them, so that the church can help those widows who are really in need.
- 17 *Let the elders that rule well be counted worthy of double honour, especially they who labour in the word and doctrine.* The elders who direct the affairs of the church well are worthy of double honor, especially those whose work is preaching and teaching.
- 18 *For the scripture saith, Thou shalt not muzzle the ox that treadeth out the corn. And, The labourer is worthy of his reward.* For Scripture says, "Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain," and "The worker deserves his wages."

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| 19 <i>Against an elder receive not an accusation, but before two or three witnesses.</i> | Do not entertain an accusation against an elder unless it is brought by two or three witnesses. |
| 20 <i>Them that sin rebuke before all, that others also may fear.</i> | But those elders who are sinning you are to reprove before everyone, so that the others may take warning. |
| 21 <i>I charge thee before God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, and the elect angels, that thou observe these things without preferring one before another, doing nothing by partiality.</i> | I charge You, in the sight of God and Christ Jesus and the elect angels, to keep these instructions without partiality, and to do nothing out of favoritism. |
| 22 <i>Lay hands suddenly on no man, neither be partaker of other men's sins: keep thyself pure.</i> | Do not be hasty in the laying on of hands, and do not share in the sins of others. Keep Yourself pure. |
| 23 <i>Drink no longer water, but use a little wine for thy stomach's sake and thine often infirmities.</i> | Stop drinking only water, and use a little wine because of Your stomach and Your frequent illnesses. |
| 24 <i>Some men's sins are open beforehand, going before to judgment; and some men they follow after.</i> | The sins of some are obvious, reaching the place of judgment ahead of them; the sins of others trail behind them. |
| 25 <i>Likewise also the good works of some are manifest beforehand; and they that are otherwise cannot be hid.</i> | In the same way, good deeds are obvious, and even those that are not obvious cannot remain hidden forever. |

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 19:32; 1 Pet 5:5-6; Titus 2:2; Gal 6:1; 1 Pet 5:1
v4 — Eph 6:1-3; Matt 15:4-6; John 19:26-27; Gen 47:12; Gen 45:10-11
v5 — Luke 2:37; 1 Tim 5:3; 1 Cor 7:32; Luke 18:1; 1 Tim 5:16
v6 — Jas 5:5; Luke 15:24; Rev 18:7; Rev 3:1; Luke 15:32
v8 — Gal 6:10; 2 Cor 12:14; Luke 11:11-13; Isa 58:7; Titus 1:16
v13 — Prov 20:19; 2 Thess 3:6-11; Acts 20:30; Prov 31:27; Titus 1:11
v14 — Titus 2:5; 1 Tim 6:1; Prov 31:27-29; 1 Cor 7:8-9; Titus 2:8

v17 — Heb 13:17; 1 Thess 5:12-13; Gal 6:6; Luke 10:7; Heb 13:7

v18 — Deut 25:4; 1 Cor 9:14; 1 Cor 9:7-10; Luke 10:7; Matt 10:10

v19 — Matt 18:16; Deut 19:15; 2 Cor 13:1; Titus 1:6; Deut 17:6

v20 — Titus 1:13; Deut 13:11; 2 Tim 4:2; 1 Tim 1:20; Acts 5:11

v22 — Eph 5:11; 1 Tim 3:10; 1 Tim 3:6; 1 Tim 4:14; Acts 6:6

Chapter 6

Paul instructs servants to honor their masters and warns against those who teach differently and do not consent to the words of the Lord Jesus Christ. He declares that the love of money is the root of all evil, and charges Timothy to fight the good fight of faith, lay hold on eternal life, and keep the commandment without spot until the appearing of the Lord Jesus Christ.

- 1 *Let as many servants as are under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honour, that the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed.* All who are under the yoke of slavery should consider their masters worthy of full respect, so that God's name and our teaching may not be slandered.
- 2 *And they that have believing masters, let them not despise them, because they are brethren; but rather do them service, because they are faithful and beloved, partakers of the benefit. These things teach and exhort.* Those who have believing masters should not show them disrespect just because they are fellow believers. Instead, they should serve them even better because their masters are dear to them as fellow believers and are devoted to the welfare of their servants. These are the things You are to teach and insist on.
- 3 *If any man teach otherwise, and consent not to wholesome words, even the words of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the doctrine which is according to godliness;* If anyone teaches otherwise and does not agree to the sound instruction of our Lord Jesus Christ and to godly teaching,
- 4 *He is proud, knowing nothing, but doting about questions and strifes of words, whereof cometh envy, strife, railings, evil surmisings,* they are conceited and understand nothing. They have an unhealthy interest in controversies and quarrels about words that result in envy, strife, malicious talk, evil suspicions,

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| 5 | <i>Perverse disputings of men of corrupt minds, and destitute of the truth, supposing that gain is godliness: from such withdraw thyself.</i> | and constant friction between people of corrupt mind, who have been robbed of the truth and who suppose that gain is godliness: from such withdraw Yourself. |
| 6 | <i>But godliness with contentment is great gain.</i> | But godliness with contentment is great gain. |
| 7 | <i>For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out.</i> | For we brought nothing into the world, and we can take nothing out of it. |
| 8 | <i>And having food and raiment let us be therewith content.</i> | But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with that. |
| 9 | <i>But they that will be rich fall into temptation and a snare, and into many foolish and hurtful lusts, which drown men in destruction and perdition.</i> | Those who want to get rich fall into temptation and a trap and into many foolish and harmful desires that plunge people into ruin and destruction. |
| 10 | <i>For the love of money is the root of all evil: which while some coveted after, they have erred from the faith, and pierced themselves through with many sorrows.</i> | For the love of money is the root of all evil; while some coveted after it, they have erred from the faith and pierced themselves through with many sorrows. |
| 11 | <i>But thou, O man of God, flee these things; and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, patience, meekness.</i> | But You, man of God, flee from all this and pursue righteousness, godliness, faith, love, endurance, and gentleness. |
| 12 | <i>Fight the good fight of faith, lay hold on eternal life, whereunto thou art also called, and hast professed a good profession before many witnesses.</i> | Fight the good fight of the faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which You were called when You made Your good confession in the presence of many witnesses. |

- 13 *I give thee charge in the sight of God, who quickeneth all things, and before Christ Jesus, who before Pontius Pilate witnessed a good confession;* In the sight of God, Who gives life to everything, and of Christ Jesus, Who while testifying before Pontius Pilate made the good confession, I charge you
- 14 *That thou keep this commandment without spot, unrebukeable, until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ:* to keep this command without spot or blame until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ,
- 15 *Which in his times he shall shew, who is the blessed and only Potentate, the King of kings, and Lord of lords;* which God will bring about in His own time — God, the blessed and only Ruler, the King of kings and Lord of lords,
- 16 *Who only hath immortality, dwelling in the light which no man can approach unto; whom no man hath seen, nor can see: to whom be honour and power everlasting. Amen.* who alone is immortal and who lives in unapproachable light, whom no one has seen or can see. To him be honor and might forever. Amen.
- 17 *Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be not highminded, nor trust in uncertain riches, but in the living God, who giveth us richly all things to enjoy;* Command those who are rich in this present world not to be arrogant nor to put their hope in wealth, which is so uncertain, but to put their hope in God, Who richly provides us with everything for our enjoyment.
- 18 *That they do good, that they be rich in good works, ready to distribute, willing to communicate;* Command them to do good, to be rich in good deeds, and to be generous and willing to share.
- 19 *Laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold on eternal life.* In this way they will lay up treasure for themselves as a firm foundation for the coming age, so that they may take hold of the life that is truly life.
- 20 *O Timothy, keep that which is committed to thy trust, avoiding profane and vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called:* Timothy, keep that which has been committed to your trust, avoiding profane and vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called,

- 21 *Which some professing have erred concerning the faith. Grace be with thee. Amen.* which some have professed and in so doing have departed from the faith. Grace be with you all.
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Pilate (*PY-lat*) — Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor of Judea — he found no fault in Jesus but allowed the crucifixion under pressure from the Jewish leaders.

Cross-References:

- v5** — 2 Pet 2:3; 2 Tim 3:5; Titus 1:11; 2 Tim 3:8; Titus 1:15-16
v6 — Heb 13:5; 1 Tim 6:8; Prov 16:8; Phil 4:11-13; Luke 12:31-32
v7 — Job 1:21; Ps 49:17; Luke 12:20-21; Eccl 5:15-16; Prov 27:24
v9 — 1 John 2:15-17; Prov 15:27; Prov 28:20-22; 1 Tim 3:7; Acts 8:20
v10 — Prov 1:19; 1 Tim 6:9; Ps 32:10; Prov 1:31; Titus 1:11
v11 — 2 Tim 2:22; 2 Tim 3:17; 1 Tim 4:12; Heb 12:14; 2 Pet 1:5-7
v12 — 1 Pet 5:10; 1 Tim 1:18; 1 Cor 9:25-26; 2 Tim 4:7; Eph 6:10-18
v15 — Rev 19:16; Rev 17:14; 1 Tim 1:17; Ps 47:2; Jer 10:10
v16 — 1 Tim 1:17; John 1:18; 1 John 1:5; Col 1:15; Ps 90:2
v17 — Prov 11:28; Acts 14:17; Matt 19:23; Prov 27:24; Jas 1:9-10
v18 — Heb 13:16; 1 John 3:17; Ps 37:3; Rom 12:8; Luke 12:21
v20 — Col 2:8; 2 Tim 2:16; 2 Tim 1:12-14; Col 2:18; 2 Tim 3:14-16

2 Timothy

Author: Paul the apostle — he names himself in 1:1. This is his final letter, written from a Roman dungeon in chains, awaiting execution under Nero.

Date written: c. AD 66–67, from Paul's second Roman imprisonment. Unlike his first imprisonment (a house arrest awaiting trial), Paul is now in a cold cell and expects to die soon (4:6).

Written to: Timothy, Paul's "dearly beloved son" in the faith (1:2). Timothy was a young pastor likely still serving the church at Ephesus. He had been raised in the Scriptures by his grandmother Lois and his mother Eunice (1:5), and converted under Paul's ministry at Lystra on the first missionary journey.

Setting: Paul writes from a Roman dungeon. He is cold (4:13), abandoned by most of his companions (1:15; 4:10, 4:16), and expecting execution at any time — "the time of my departure is at hand" (4:6). The letter is deeply personal. It is partly a final charge to faithful ministry, and partly an urgent plea for Timothy to come quickly before winter (4:9, 4:21). Onesiphorus is praised for searching out Paul in his prison; Demas is named for forsaking him. Only Luke remains. Tradition holds that Paul was beheaded by Nero shortly after writing.

Where this sits historically: Written from a Roman dungeon at the height of Nero's persecution of Christians (AD 64–68), just before Paul's martyrdom on the Ostian Way and only a few years before Jerusalem fell to Titus in AD 70.

Contemporaries: Peter had likely already been crucified in Rome, Luke remained with Paul, and the Jewish revolt (begun AD 66) was raging in Judea as Paul wrote his final letter.

Big themes:

- Faithful endurance in ministry under persecution — "endure hardness, as a good soldier of Jesus Christ" (2:3)
- The deposit of sound doctrine entrusted by Paul to Timothy, to be passed on to faithful men (2:2)
- The inspiration and sufficiency of Scripture — "All scripture is given by inspiration of God" (3:16–17)
- The apostle's confidence in Christ in the face of death — "I know whom I have believed" (1:12)
- The danger of false teachers in the last days, and the duty to preach the word (3:1–9; 4:1–4)
- The crown of righteousness laid up for all who love His appearing (4:8)
- Loneliness and the comfort of Christ — "Only Luke is with me" (4:11); "the Lord stood with me" (4:17)

Key passages: 2 Timothy 1:7; 2:15; 3:16–17; 4:2; 4:6–8

How it fits: 2 Timothy is Paul's last will and testament. It is the most personal of the Pastoral Epistles. Where 1 Timothy and Titus are concerned with church order, 2 Timothy is a dying

apostle's farewell — solemn, intimate, full of the names of those who stood with him and those who fell away. The declaration of 3:16 ("All scripture is given by inspiration of God...") has shaped the church's doctrine of Scripture more than any other single verse.

Chapter 1

Paul writes to his beloved son Timothy, thanking God for Timothy's unfeigned faith and urging him not to be ashamed of the testimony of the Lord nor of Paul as His prisoner. He reminds Timothy that God has not given us the spirit of fear but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind, and charges him to hold fast the pattern of sound words.

- 1

Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, according to the promise of life which is in Christ Jesus,

From Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, according to the promise of life which is in Christ Jesus

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- 2

To Timothy, my dearly beloved son: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

to Timothy, my dearly beloved son: Grace, mercy, and peace to You from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Timothy** (TIM-uh-thee) — KJV "Timotheus" — "honoring God" — Paul's "dearly beloved son" in the faith; converted under Paul's ministry at Lystra (Acts 16:1); half-Greek, half-Jewish; raised by his godly mother and grandmother in the Scriptures; pastor of the Ephesian church. The Modern column uses the Anglicized "Timothy," matching the title of the book.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. Mercy is God withholding the wrath we have earned. Grace gives us what we don't deserve; mercy spares us from what we do deserve. Both flow from God's heart toward sinners.

- 3

I thank God, whom I serve from my forefathers with pure conscience, that without ceasing I have remembrance of thee in my prayers night and day;

I thank God — whom I serve, as my forefathers did, with a pure conscience — as I remember You constantly in my prayers night and day.
- 4

Greatly desiring to see thee, being mindful of thy tears, that I may be filled with joy;

I long to see You. I remember Your tears, and I want to be filled with joy.

- 5

When I call to remembrance the unfeigned faith that is in thee, which dwelt first in thy grandmother Lois, and thy mother Eunice; and I am persuaded that in thee also.
- I am reminded of the sincere faith that is in You — the faith that first lived in Your grandmother Lois and in Your mother Eunice, and which, I am persuaded, lives in You also.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Lois** (LOH-iss) — Timothy's grandmother; one of the earliest believers Paul names. She passed the faith on to her daughter Eunice, who passed it on to Timothy — a portrait of generational discipleship.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Eunice** (YOO-niss) — "good victory" — Timothy's mother; a Jewish woman who married a Greek (Acts 16:1); she raised Timothy in the Hebrew Scriptures from a child (3:15).

- 6

Wherefore I put thee in remembrance that thou stir up the gift of God, which is in thee by the putting on of my hands.
- For this reason I remind You to stir up the gift of God which is in You through the laying on of my hands.
- 7

For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.
- For God has not given us the spirit of fear, but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.
- 8

Be not thou therefore ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, nor of me his prisoner: but be thou partaker of the afflictions of the gospel according to the power of God;
- So do not be ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, or of me His prisoner. Instead, share in the afflictions of the gospel, according to the power of God.
- 9

Who hath saved us, and called us with an holy calling, not according to our works, but according to his own purpose and grace, which was given us in Christ Jesus before the world began,
- He has saved us and called us with a holy calling — not because of our works, but because of His own purpose and grace, which was given us in Christ Jesus before the world began,
- 10

But is now made manifest by the appearing of our Saviour Jesus Christ, who hath abolished death, and hath brought life and immortality to light through the gospel:
- and which is now made manifest by the appearing of our Saviour Jesus Christ, Who has abolished death and has brought life and immortality to light through the gospel.

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| 11 <i>Whereunto I am appointed a preacher, and an apostle, and a teacher of the Gentiles.</i> | I was appointed a preacher, an apostle, and a teacher of the Gentiles for this gospel. |
| 12 <i>For the which cause I also suffer these things: nevertheless I am not ashamed: for I know whom I have believed, and am persuaded that he is able to keep that which I have committed unto him against that day.</i> | And that is why I suffer these things. Yet I am not ashamed — for I know whom I have believed, and I am persuaded that He is able to keep what I have committed to Him against that day. |
| 13 <i>Hold fast the form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.</i> | Hold fast the pattern of sound words which You have heard from me, in the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" is the older English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is not a force or an influence — He is a person, fully God, who dwells in every believer and gives power for life and witness.*

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| 14 <i>That good thing which was committed unto thee keep by the Holy Ghost which dwelleth in us.</i> | Guard that good thing which was committed to You — by the Holy Ghost Who dwells in us. |
| 15 <i>This thou knowest, that all they which are in Asia be turned away from me; of whom are Phygellus and Hermogenes.</i> | You know this, that all those who are in Asia have turned away from me, among whom are Phygellus and Hermogenes. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Phygellus and Hermogenes** (fy-JEL-us; her-MOJ-eh-neeZ) — *Two men in the province of Asia (likely Ephesus) who deserted Paul during his imprisonment. Nothing else is known of them — their names are preserved only as a warning.*

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| 16 <i>The Lord give mercy unto the house of Onesiphorus; for he oft refreshed me, and was not ashamed of my chain:</i> | May the Lord show mercy to the household of Onesiphorus, for He often refreshed me and was not ashamed of my chains. |
| 17 <i>But, when he was in Rome, he sought me out very diligently, and found me.</i> | When He was in Rome, He searched for me diligently and found me. |

- 18 *The Lord grant unto him that he may find mercy of the Lord in that day: and in how many things he ministered unto me at Ephesus, thou knowest very well.*
- May the Lord grant that He find mercy from the Lord on that day! And You know very well how many ways He ministered to me at Ephesus.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Onesiphorus** (on-eh-SIF-or-us) — "bringing profit" — A Christian from Ephesus who searched out Paul in his Roman imprisonment and refreshed him. To be associated publicly with a condemned prisoner was dangerous; Onesiphorus did it anyway. Paul commends his household twice (here and at 4:19).

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 9:15; John 17:3; 2 Cor 1:1; John 10:28
- v3 — Rom 1:8-9; Heb 13:8; Acts 24:14; Acts 23:1; Acts 22:3
- v5 — 1 Tim 1:5; Acts 16:1; 2 Tim 3:15; 1 Tim 4:6; 2 Cor 6:6
- v6 — 1 Tim 4:14; 1 Pet 4:10-11; Rom 12:6-8; 1 Thess 5:19; 2 Pet 3:1
- v7 — Rom 8:15; 1 John 4:18; John 14:27; Gal 5:22; Luke 10:19
- v8 — Rom 1:16; Mark 8:38; 1 Pet 4:13-15; 2 Tim 4:5; Rev 12:11
- v9 — Eph 2:8-9; Titus 3:4-5; Eph 1:3-4; Rom 16:25; Rom 11:5-6
- v10 — 1 John 1:2; Rom 16:26; Titus 2:11; 2 Pet 3:18; Heb 2:14-15
- v12 — Jude 1:24; 2 Tim 1:8; 1 Pet 4:19; 2 Tim 4:8; Heb 7:25
- v13 — Titus 1:9; 2 Tim 3:14; Phil 4:9; Rom 6:17; 2 Tim 2:2
- v14 — John 14:17; Rom 8:13; 1 Tim 6:20; 1 Cor 3:16; 2 Tim 1:12
- v16 — 2 Tim 4:19; Phlm 1:20; Phlm 1:7; Heb 10:34; Eph 6:20

Chapter 2

Paul charges Timothy to be strong in grace and to endure hardness as a good soldier of Jesus Christ, committing what he has heard to faithful men who can teach others. He instructs Timothy to study to show himself approved unto God, a workman that needs not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth, and to flee youthful lusts while pursuing righteousness, faith, charity, and peace.

- 1 *Thou therefore, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus.*
- You therefore, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus.

- 2 *And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.* And the things that You have heard from me in the presence of many witnesses — commit these to faithful men who will be able to teach others also.
- 3 *Thou therefore endure hardness, as a good soldier of Jesus Christ.* You therefore endure hardness, as a good soldier of Jesus Christ.
- 4 *No man that warreth entangleth himself with the affairs of this life; that he may please him who hath chosen him to be a soldier.* No soldier on active duty gets entangled in the affairs of civilian life — his aim is to please the one who enlisted him.
- 5 *And if a man also strive for masteries, yet is he not crowned, except he strive lawfully.* And if a man competes as an athlete, he is not crowned unless He competes by the rules.
- 6 *The husbandman that laboureth must be first partaker of the fruits.* The hardworking farmer must be the first to share in the crops.
- 7 *Consider what I say; and the Lord give thee understanding in all things.* Consider what I say, and the Lord give You understanding in all things.
- 8 *Remember that Jesus Christ of the seed of David was raised from the dead according to my gospel:* Remember that Jesus Christ, of the seed of David, was raised from the dead, according to my gospel —
- 9 *Wherein I suffer trouble, as an evil doer, even unto bonds; but the word of God is not bound.* for which I suffer trouble, even as a criminal, to the point of chains. But the word of God is not chained.
- 10 *Therefore I endure all things for the elect's sakes, that they may also obtain the salvation which is in Christ Jesus with eternal glory.* Therefore I endure all things for the sake of the elect, that they also may obtain the salvation which is in Christ Jesus, with eternal glory.
- 11 *It is a faithful saying: For if we be dead with him, we shall also live with him:* This is a faithful saying: If we died with Him, we shall also live with Him;
- 12 *If we suffer, we shall also reign with him: if we deny him, he also will deny us:* if we endure, we shall also reign with Him; if we deny Him, He also will deny us;

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| 13 <i>If we believe not, yet he abideth faithful: he cannot deny himself.</i> | if we are faithless, He remains faithful — He cannot deny Himself. |
| 14 <i>Of these things put them in remembrance, charging them before the Lord that they strive not about words to no profit, but to the subverting of the hearers.</i> | Remind them of these things, charging them before the Lord not to quarrel about words. It accomplishes nothing — it only ruins those who listen. |
| 15 <i>Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.</i> | Study to show Yourself approved to God, a workman who does not need to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth. |
| 16 <i>But shun profane and vain babblings: for they will increase unto more ungodliness.</i> | Shun profane and empty chatter, for it will lead to more and more ungodliness. |
| 17 <i>And their word will eat as doth a canker: of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus;</i> | And their word will eat away like a canker — among them are Hymenaeus and Philetus, |
| 18 <i>Who concerning the truth have erred, saying that the resurrection is past already; and overthrow the faith of some.</i> | who have strayed from the truth, saying that the resurrection has already happened, and they overthrow the faith of some. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — *Hymenaeus and Philetus* (hy-meh-NEE-us; fih-LEE-tus) — False teachers in the Ephesian region who taught that the resurrection had already taken place — likely spiritualizing it as something already received at conversion. Their error was destroying real faith. Hymenaeus is also named at 1 Timothy 1:20, where Paul says he has "delivered him unto Satan."

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| 19 <i>Nevertheless the foundation of God standeth sure, having this seal, The Lord knoweth them that are his. And, Let every one that nameth the name of Christ depart from iniquity.</i> | Nevertheless, the foundation of God stands firm, having this seal: "The Lord knows those who are His," and, "Let every one who names the name of Christ depart from iniquity." |
| 20 <i>But in a great house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of earth; and some to honour, and some to dishonour.</i> | In a great house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of clay — some for honor and some for dishonor. |

- 21

If a man therefore purge himself from these, he shall be a vessel unto honour, sanctified, and meet for the master's use, and prepared unto every good work.
- So if anyone cleanses himself from these things, he will be a vessel for honor — sanctified, useful for the Master, prepared for every good work.
- 22

Flee also youthful lusts: but follow righteousness, faith, charity, peace, with them that call on the Lord out of a pure heart.
- Flee youthful lusts. Pursue righteousness, faith, charity, and peace, along with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

- 23

But foolish and unlearned questions avoid, knowing that they do gender strifes.
- Avoid foolish and ignorant arguments, knowing that they breed strife.
- 24

And the servant of the Lord must not strive; but be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient,
- And the servant of the Lord must not be quarrelsome, but gentle to all, able to teach, patient,
- 25

In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth;
- in meekness instructing those who oppose themselves — God perhaps will grant them repentance, so that they may come to the acknowledging of the truth,
- 26

And that they may recover themselves out of the snare of the devil, who are taken captive by him at his will.
- and they may come to their senses and escape the snare of the devil, who has taken them captive to do his will.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 12:9-10; Eph 6:10; 2 Tim 1:7; Phil 4:13; 1 Cor 16:13
- v2 — 2 Tim 1:13-14; 1 Tim 4:6; 1 Tim 6:12; Mal 2:7; Titus 1:5-9
- v3 — Heb 12:2-3; Jas 1:12; 2 Tim 4:5; Eph 6:11-18; 2 Tim 1:8
- v4 — 1 Thess 2:4; Luke 8:14; 2 Pet 2:20; 1 Cor 9:25-26; 1 Cor 7:22-23
- v12 — Rom 8:17; Matt 10:33; Rev 20:4; Luke 12:9; Rev 20:6

v13 — Num 23:19; Rom 3:3; 1 Thess 5:24; 2 Thess 3:3; Titus 1:2
v15 — 1 Thess 2:4; 2 Pet 1:10; 1 Tim 4:6; 2 Cor 10:18; 2 Cor 5:9
v19 — John 10:14; 1 Cor 8:3; Nah 1:7; 1 John 3:7-10; Num 16:5
v20 — Rom 9:21-23; 1 Tim 3:15; 1 Pet 2:5; 1 Cor 3:9; Ezra 1:6
v21 — 2 Tim 3:17; Eph 2:10; Ps 119:9; 2 Cor 7:1; 1 Pet 1:22
v22 — 1 Pet 2:11; 1 Pet 3:11; 1 Cor 6:18; 1 Tim 6:11; Ps 119:9
v24 — Titus 3:2; Jas 1:19-20; Titus 1:7; 1 Tim 3:2-3; 1 Thess 2:7

Chapter 3

Paul warns that in the last days perilous times shall come, with men being lovers of their own selves, covetous, boasters, and lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God. He reminds Timothy that all who will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution, and declares that all scripture is given by inspiration of God and is profitable for doctrine, reproof, correction, and instruction in righteousness.

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| 1 <i>This know also, that in the last days
 perilous times shall come.</i> | Know this also: in the last days,
perilous times shall come. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Perilous* (PER-ih-lus) — *Dangerous, harsh, threatening. The Greek word here is the same one used in Matthew 8:28 to describe the violent demoniacs who were so fierce that no one could pass that way. Paul is warning Timothy that the days ahead are not just difficult — they are spiritually savage.*

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| 2 <i>For men shall be lovers of their own
 selves, covetous, boasters, proud,
 blasphemers, disobedient to parents,
 unthankful, unholy,</i> | For men shall be lovers of themselves,
covetous, boasters, proud,
blasphemers, disobedient to parents,
unthankful, unholy, |
| 3 <i>Without natural affection,
 trucebreakers, false accusers,
 incontinent, fierce, despisers of those
 that are good,</i> | without natural affection,
trucebreakers, false accusers, without
self-control, fierce, despisers of those
who are good, |
| 4 <i>Traitors, heady, highminded, lovers of
 pleasures more than lovers of God;</i> | traitors, reckless, conceited, lovers of
pleasures more than lovers of God — |
| 5 <i>Having a form of godliness, but
 denying the power thereof: from such
 turn away.</i> | having a form of godliness, but
denying its power. From such people
turn away. |

- 6 *For of this sort are they which creep into houses, and lead captive silly women laden with sins, led away with divers lusts,* For of this sort are those who creep into houses and lead captive silly women loaded down with sins, led away by various lusts,
- 7 *Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.* ever learning, but never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jannes and Jambres** (JAN-eez; JAM-breez) — Jewish tradition names these as the two Egyptian magicians who opposed Moses before Pharaoh (Exodus 7); they imitated Moses's signs at first but were finally exposed. Paul cites them as types of the false teachers in the last days — men who counterfeit the truth but cannot in the end stand against it.

- 8 *Now as Jannes and Jambres withstood Moses, so do these also resist the truth: men of corrupt minds, reprobate concerning the faith.* Now as Jannes and Jambres withstood Moses, so these also resist the truth — men of corrupt minds, reprobate concerning the faith.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Reprobate** (REP-ro-bayt) — Rejected, disqualified, failing the test. Originally used of metal that proved counterfeit when tested; spiritually, of those who claim faith but are shown false when tried. To be "reprobate concerning the faith" is to be exposed as having no real share in it.

- 9 *But they shall proceed no further: for their folly shall be manifest unto all men, as theirs also was.* But they shall proceed no further, for their folly shall be made manifest to all men — as theirs also was.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient endurance with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. Longsuffering is not weakness — it is strength held back. God is longsuffering toward sinners, bearing with them rather than judging immediately, and He calls His servants to the same patience.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Doctrine** (DOK-trin) — Teaching; specifically, the body of truth God has revealed. Doctrine is not academic theory — it is what we are to believe, live by, and pass on. Paul will use the word again in 3:16 ("profitable for doctrine") and 4:2–3.

- 10 *But thou hast fully known my doctrine, manner of life, purpose, faith, longsuffering, charity, patience,* But you have fully known my doctrine, manner of life, purpose, faith, longsuffering, charity, patience,

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| <p>11 <i>Persecutions, afflictions, which came unto me at Antioch, at Iconium, at Lystra; what persecutions I endured: but out of them all the Lord delivered me.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.</i></p> <p>13 <i>But evil men and seducers shall wax worse and worse, deceiving, and being deceived.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But continue thou in the things which thou hast learned and hast been assured of, knowing of whom thou hast learned them;</i></p> <p>15 <i>And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.</i></p> <p>16 <i>All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:</i></p> <p>17 <i>That the man of God may be perfect, thoroughly furnished unto all good works.</i></p> | <p>persecutions, afflictions — what came to me at Antioch, at Iconium, at Lystra; what persecutions I endured. But out of them all the Lord delivered me.</p> <p>Yes, and all who will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.</p> <p>But evil men and impostors shall grow worse and worse, deceiving and being deceived.</p> <p>But You continue in the things which You have learned and have been assured of, knowing from whom You have learned them —</p> <p>and that from childhood You have known the holy scriptures, which are able to make You wise to salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.</p> <p>All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness,</p> <p>that the man of God may be perfect, thoroughly furnished for every good work.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Pet 3:3; 2 Tim 4:3; 1 Tim 4:1-3; 1 John 2:18; 2 Thess 2:3-12
- v2 — Phil 2:21; Rom 1:29-31; Ps 10:3; Jude 1:16; 2 Tim 3:4
- v5 — Isa 29:13; Titus 1:16; Matt 23:27-28; 1 Tim 5:8; Rom 2:20-24
- v6 — Jude 1:4; 2 Pet 3:17; Titus 3:3; Titus 1:11; Jude 1:18
- v7 — 2 Tim 4:3-4; Eph 4:14; 1 Tim 2:4; Heb 5:11; 2 Tim 2:25
- v8 — Acts 13:8-11; Ex 7:11; Rev 2:20; 1 Tim 6:5; Eph 4:14
- v10 — 1 Tim 6:11; Titus 2:7; 2 Pet 1:5-7; Phil 2:22; 1 Tim 4:6

v12 — 1 Pet 3:14; 1 Pet 4:12-16; 1 Pet 2:20-21; Acts 14:22; Matt 5:10-12

v14 — 1 Thess 2:13; 2 Tim 2:2; 2 Tim 1:13; 1 Thess 1:5; Heb 10:22

v15 — Ps 119:98-99; Luke 24:45; Prov 22:6; 2 Pet 1:20-21; Matt 22:29

v16 — Rom 15:4; Heb 4:12; 2 Pet 1:19-21; Mark 12:24; Ps 19:7-11

v17 — 2 Tim 2:21; 2 Cor 9:8; Eph 2:10; 1 Tim 6:11; Heb 10:24

Chapter 4

Paul charges Timothy to preach the word in season and out of season, warning that the time will come when men will not endure sound doctrine but will heap to themselves teachers having itching ears. Paul declares that he has fought a good fight, finished his course, and kept the faith, and that a crown of righteousness is laid up for him which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give him at that day.

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| <p>1 <i>I charge thee therefore before God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, who shall judge the quick and the dead at his appearing and his kingdom;</i></p> | <p>I charge You therefore before God and the Lord Jesus Christ, Who shall judge the quick and the dead at His appearing and His kingdom:</p> |
| <p>2 <i>Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine.</i></p> | <p>Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort, with all longsuffering and doctrine.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears;</i></p> | <p>For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine, but according to their own lusts they shall heap up for themselves teachers, having itching ears.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And they shall turn away their ears from the truth, and shall be turned unto fables.</i></p> | <p>They shall turn away their ears from the truth and be turned to fables.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>But watch thou in all things, endure afflictions, do the work of an evangelist, make full proof of thy ministry.</i></p> | <p>But watch in all things; endure afflictions; do the work of an evangelist; make full proof of Your ministry.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>For I am now ready to be offered, and the time of my departure is at hand.</i></p> | <p>For I am now ready to be poured out as an offering, and the time of my departure is at hand.</p> |

- 7

I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith:

I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith.
- 8

Henceforth there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give me at that day: and not to me only, but unto all them also that love his appearing.

From now on there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give me at that day — and not to me only, but to all them also that love His appearing.
- 9

Do thy diligence to come shortly unto me:

Do Your diligence to come to me shortly.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Demas** (DEE-mas) — Once named in Philemon (v24) and Colossians (4:14) as one of Paul's "fellow workers"; now Paul writes that Demas "hath forsaken me, having loved this present world." A solemn warning preserved in Scripture by name. The love of this present world has carried away those who once stood with the apostle.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Crescens** (KRES-enz) — A companion of Paul who has gone to Galatia; nothing further is known of him.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Titus** (TY-tus) — A Greek convert and longtime companion of Paul (Galatians 2:1); the recipient of the Epistle to Titus; he has gone to Dalmatia (the coastland of modern Croatia).

- 10

For Demas hath forsaken me, having loved this present world, and is departed unto Thessalonica; Crescens to Galatia, Titus unto Dalmatia.

For Demas has forsaken me, having loved this present world, and has departed to Thessalonica; Crescens has gone to Galatia, and Titus to Dalmatia.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Luke** (KJV "Lucas") — Greek physician; the close traveling companion of Paul on much of his ministry; author of the Gospel of Luke and the book of Acts. At this final hour he is the only one of Paul's companions still at his side: "Only Luke is with me."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mark** (KJV "Marcus") — Cousin of Barnabas; abandoned Paul on the first missionary journey (Acts 13:13; 15:37–38), which once caused such a sharp division that Paul and Barnabas parted ways. Now Paul calls for him: "he is profitable to me for the ministry." A picture of restoration.

- 11

Only Luke is with me. Take Mark, and bring him with thee: for he is profitable to me for the ministry.

Only Luke is with me. Take Mark and bring him with you, for he is profitable to me for the ministry.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tychicus** (TIK-ih-kus) — "fortunate" — *A faithful messenger of Paul (Acts 20:4; Eph 6:21; Col 4:7); Paul has now sent him to Ephesus, very possibly carrying this very letter and relieving Timothy so Timothy can come to Rome.*

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| 12 <i>And Tychicus have I sent to Ephesus.</i> | I have sent Tychicus to Ephesus. |
| 13 <i>The cloke that I left at Troas with Carpus, when thou comest, bring with thee, and the books, but especially the parchments.</i> | When you come, bring the cloak that I left at Troas with Carpus, and the books — especially the parchments. |
| 14 <i>Alexander the coppersmith did me much evil: the Lord reward him according to his works:</i> | Alexander the coppersmith did me much harm. The Lord will repay Him according to His works. |
| 15 <i>Of whom be thou ware also; for he hath greatly withstood our words.</i> | Be on guard against him yourself, for he has greatly opposed our words. |
| 16 <i>At my first answer no man stood with me, but all men forsook me: I pray God that it may not be laid to their charge.</i> | At my first defense no one stood with me — all forsook me. May it not be charged against them. |
| 17 <i>Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me, and strengthened me; that by me the preaching might be fully known, and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion.</i> | But the Lord stood with me and strengthened me, so that through me the preaching might be fully proclaimed and all the Gentiles might hear it. And I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion. |
| 18 <i>And the Lord shall deliver me from every evil work, and will preserve me unto his heavenly kingdom: to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.</i> | And the Lord shall deliver me from every evil work and will preserve me to His heavenly kingdom. To Him be glory for ever and ever. Amen. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Prisca and Aquila** (PRIS-kah; uh-KWILL-uh) — *A Christian couple; tentmakers like Paul; close ministry partners across many years (Acts 18; Romans 16:3; 1 Corinthians 16:19). "Prisca" is the formal Latin name of which "Priscilla" is the affectionate form. They are now apparently at Ephesus, where Paul sends his greetings through Timothy.*

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| 19 <i>Salute Prisca and Aquila, and the household of Onesiphorus.</i> | Greet Prisca and Aquila, and the household of Onesiphorus. |
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20 *Erastus abode at Corinth: but Trophimus have I left at Miletum sick.* Erastus stayed at Corinth, but I left Trophimus sick at Miletum.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Trophimus** (TROF-ih-mus) — A Christian from Ephesus (Acts 20:4; 21:29); Paul has left him at Miletum because he was sick. A striking note: even an apostle whose handkerchiefs once healed the sick (Acts 19:12) does not now heal his own beloved companion. Healing is in God's hand, not Paul's.

21 *Do thy diligence to come before winter. Eubulus greeteth thee, and Pudens, and Linus, and Claudia, and all the brethren.* Do your diligence to come before winter. Eubulus greets you, and so do Pudens, Linus, Claudia, and all the brethren.

22 *The Lord Jesus Christ be with thy spirit. Grace be with you. Amen.* The Lord Jesus Christ be with Your spirit. Grace be with You. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Acts 10:42; 2 Tim 4:8; 1 Tim 5:21; Matt 16:27; 2 Tim 2:14
- v2 — 1 Thess 5:14; 1 Tim 4:15-16; Rev 3:19; 1 Tim 4:13; Titus 2:15
- v3 — 2 Pet 2:1-3; 2 Tim 3:1-6; 1 Tim 4:1-3; 1 Tim 1:10; Gal 4:16
- v4 — Zech 7:11; 1 Tim 1:4; Acts 7:57; 2 Pet 1:16; 1 Tim 4:7
- v5 — 2 Tim 1:8; 2 Tim 2:3; 1 Pet 1:13; Col 4:17; 2 Tim 3:10-12
- v6 — Phil 1:23; Phil 2:17
- v7 — 1 Tim 6:12; 1 Cor 9:24-27; Heb 12:1-2; Acts 20:24; Phil 3:13-14
- v8 — Jas 1:12; Rev 2:10; 1 Pet 5:4; Matt 6:19-20; 1 Pet 1:4
- v10 — 1 John 2:15-16; 2 Tim 1:15; Col 4:14-15; 1 John 5:4-5; Phlm 1:24
- v14 — 1 Tim 1:20; 2 Thess 1:6; Ps 28:4; 1 Sam 24:12
- v17 — 1 Pet 5:8; Phil 1:12-14; Ps 22:21; 1 Sam 17:37; Dan 6:22
- v18 — Ps 121:7; 2 Thess 3:3; Jude 1:24-25; Matt 6:13; 1 Thess 5:23

Titus

Author: Paul the apostle — he names himself in v1:1 as "a servant of God, and an apostle of Jesus Christ."

Date written: c. AD 62–66, between Paul's first and second Roman imprisonments. Titus is one of the three Pastoral Epistles (with 1 Timothy and 2 Timothy), written after Paul's release from his first Roman imprisonment and before his final arrest under Nero.

Written to: Titus, a Greek Christian convert and trusted ministry partner of Paul (Gal 2:1–3; 2 Cor 7–8). Paul had left him on the island of Crete to organize the churches there.

Setting: Paul had evangelized Crete with Titus during a missionary stop not recorded in Acts — probably between his release from his first Roman imprisonment (c. AD 62) and his second arrest (c. AD 67). He left Titus there to appoint elders in every city, correct unruly converts, and combat false teachers — especially Judaizers and those given to "Jewish fables." The letter gives Titus pastoral instructions on church order, qualifications for elders, and how sound doctrine produces godly living.

Where this sits historically: Written under Nero between Paul's two Roman imprisonments, when the emperor's rule was hardening toward Christians but no organized empire-wide persecution had yet begun.

Contemporaries: Titus served on Crete while Timothy ministered at Ephesus, Apollos was traveling (3:13), and Paul wrote 1 Timothy in the same window.

Big themes:

- Sound doctrine produces godly living — what we believe shapes how we live
- The qualifications of elders and bishops — character before gifting
- Roles in the household of faith — older men, older women, younger men, younger women, and servants
- The grace of God teaches us to deny ungodliness and worldly lusts
- The glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ — one of the New Testament's clearest deity-of-Christ statements
- Salvation by grace through regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost, not by works of righteousness
- How to handle heretics in the church — admonish twice, then reject

Key passages: Titus 1:5–9 (elder qualifications); 2:11–14 (grace teaches us); 3:5–7 (regeneration and justification)

How it fits: Titus is the middle Pastoral Epistle and the most concise of the three. With 1 and 2 Timothy, it forms Paul's practical handbook on how Christian churches should be ordered, what doctrine the church must teach, and how godly leaders are recognized and appointed. The doxology in 2:13 — "the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ" — is one of the New Testament's clearest deity-of-Christ statements, the Father and the Son named together as the

one great God of our salvation.

Chapter 1

Paul writes to Titus, whom he left in Crete to set things in order and ordain elders in every city. He sets forth the qualifications for elders — blameless, not self-willed, not given to wine, holding fast the faithful word — and warns against false teachers, especially those of the circumcision, who subvert whole houses for dishonest gain.

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Paul, a servant of God, and an apostle of Jesus Christ, according to the faith of God's elect, and the acknowledging of the truth which is after godliness;

From Paul, a servant of God, and an apostle of Jesus Christ — sent for the faith of God's chosen ones and for the knowledge of the truth that leads to godliness,
- 2

In hope of eternal life, which God, that cannot lie, promised before the world began;

in the hope of eternal life, which God — who cannot lie — promised before the world began,
- 3

But hath in due times manifested his word through preaching, which is committed unto me according to the commandment of God our Saviour;

and has now in His own time made known His word through the preaching that was entrusted to me by the command of God our Saviour —
- 4

To Titus, mine own son after the common faith: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ our Saviour.

to Titus, my own son in the faith we share: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ our Saviour.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Titus** (TY-tus) — A Greek convert (Gal 2:3) and a trusted ministry partner of Paul, sent on hard assignments — first to Corinth, now to Crete. He is the recipient of this letter and the namesake of the book.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. Mercy is God withholding the wrath we have earned. Grace gives us what we don't deserve; mercy spares us from what we do deserve. Both flow from God's heart toward sinners.

- 5 *For this cause left I thee in Crete, that thou shouldest set in order the things that are wanting, and ordain elders in every city, as I had appointed thee:* The reason I left You in Crete was this: that You should set in order the things that are still lacking, and ordain elders in every city, as I directed You.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Crete** (KREET) — A large Mediterranean island south of Greece; the location of Titus's ministry and the setting of this letter.

- 6 *If any be blameless, the husband of one wife, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.* An elder must be blameless — the husband of one wife, with faithful children who are not accused of wild living or rebellion.
- 7 *For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;* For a bishop must be blameless, as God's steward — not self-willed, not quick-tempered, not given to wine, not violent, not greedy for dishonest gain,
- 8 *But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;* but a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, and self-controlled,
- 9 *Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.* holding firmly to the faithful word as He has been taught, so that He may be able by sound doctrine both to encourage others and to refute those who contradict it.
- 10 *For there are many unruly and vain talkers and deceivers, specially they of the circumcision:* For there are many who are unruly — empty talkers and deceivers — especially those of the circumcision.
- 11 *Whose mouths must be stopped, who subvert whole houses, teaching things which they ought not, for filthy lucre's sake.* Their mouths must be stopped. They are upsetting whole households, teaching things they ought not to teach — and all for dishonest gain.
- 12 *One of themselves, even a prophet of their own, said, The Cretians are always liars, evil beasts, slow bellies.* One of their own, a prophet of theirs, said, "The Cretians are always liars, evil beasts, lazy gluttons."

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cretians** (KREE-shuns) — Inhabitants of Crete. Paul here quotes one of their own prophets — Epimenides of Crete, who lived in the 6th century BC.

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| 13 <i>This witness is true. Wherefore rebuke them sharply, that they may be sound in the faith;</i> | This testimony is true. Therefore rebuke them sharply, so that they may be sound in the faith — |
| 14 <i>Not giving heed to Jewish fables, and commandments of men, that turn from the truth.</i> | not paying attention to Jewish fables or to the commandments of men who turn away from the truth. |
| 15 <i>Unto the pure all things are pure: but unto them that are defiled and unbelieving is nothing pure; but even their mind and conscience is defiled.</i> | To the pure, all things are pure; but to those who are defiled and unbelieving, nothing is pure — even their mind and conscience are defiled. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Reprobate** (REP-roh-bate) — *failing the test; rejected after examination. A reprobate person or work is one God has tested and found worthless — unfit, disapproved, set aside. Paul says these false teachers claim to know God, but their works prove them rejected.*

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| 16 <i>They profess that they know God; but in works they deny him, being abominable, and disobedient, and unto every good work reprobate.</i> | They claim to know God, but by their works they deny Him. They are detestable, disobedient, and unfit for any good work. |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 1:1; 1 Tim 6:3; 2 Tim 2:23; Titus 2:11-12; 2 Pet 1:3
- v2 — Num 23:19; 2 Tim 1:9; 1 John 2:25; Heb 6:17-18; 1 John 5:11-13
- v3 — 1 Tim 1:11; 1 Tim 1:1; Titus 3:4-6; Titus 2:10
- v5 — Acts 14:23; 1 Tim 1:3; Eccl 12:9; 1 Cor 14:40
- v7 — Eph 5:18; 2 Pet 2:10; 1 Pet 4:10; 1 Pet 5:2; Luke 12:42
- v9 — 2 Thess 2:15; 2 Tim 1:13; 1 Tim 6:3; 1 Tim 1:10; Rev 3:3
- v10 — 1 Tim 1:6; 1 John 4:1; Gal 2:4
- v11 — 2 Tim 3:6; 1 Tim 6:5; Titus 3:10; Rom 3:19; Ps 63:11
- v13 — 1 Tim 5:20; Titus 2:2; Titus 2:15; 2 Tim 4:2; 2 Cor 13:10
- v14 — 2 Tim 4:4; Col 2:22; Gal 4:9; 2 Pet 2:22; Matt 15:9
- v15 — Rom 14:14; Rom 14:20; 1 Cor 10:23; 1 Tim 4:3-4; Matt 15:18
- v16 — 1 John 2:4; Isa 29:13; Eph 5:6; Ezek 33:31; 2 Tim 3:5-8

Chapter 2

Paul instructs Titus to teach sound doctrine: that aged men be sober, aged women reverent, young women love their husbands, and young men be sober-minded. He declares that the grace of God that brings salvation has appeared to all men, teaching us to deny ungodliness and worldly lusts and to live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present world, looking for the blessed hope and glorious appearing of our great God and Saviour Jesus Christ.

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| 1 | <i>But speak thou the things which become sound doctrine:</i> | But as for You, speak the things that are fitting for sound doctrine. |
| 2 | <i>That the aged men be sober, grave, temperate, sound in faith, in charity, in patience.</i> | Teach the older men to be sober, dignified, self-controlled, and sound in faith, in charity, and in patience. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Charity** (CHAIR-ih-tee) — love that gives itself for others; sacrificial, selfless, godly love. Modern translations often say "love," but charity carries a fuller meaning — it is love that costs something, love that chooses others over self, the kind of love that only God can produce in us.

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| 3 | <i>The aged women likewise, that they be in behaviour as becometh holiness, not false accusers, not given to much wine, teachers of good things;</i> | Teach the older women in the same way — that they be reverent in behavior, not slanderers, not enslaved to much wine, but teachers of good things, |
| 4 | <i>That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children,</i> | so that they may train the young women to love their husbands and to love their children, |
| 5 | <i>To be discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.</i> | to be discreet, chaste, keepers at home, kind, and obedient to their own husbands — so that the word of God is not spoken against. |
| 6 | <i>Young men likewise exhort to be sober minded.</i> | In the same way, urge the young men to be sober-minded. |
| 7 | <i>In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity,</i> | In all things, show Yourself to be a pattern of good works. In Your teaching show integrity, dignity, and sincerity, |

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| 8 <i>Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.</i> | with sound speech that cannot be condemned — so that the opponent may be put to shame, having nothing evil to say about You. |
| 9 <i>Exhort servants to be obedient unto their own masters, and to please them well in all things; not answering again;</i> | Urge servants to be obedient to their own masters and to please them well in all things — not talking back, |
| 10 <i>Not purloining, but shewing all good fidelity; that they may adorn the doctrine of God our Saviour in all things.</i> | not stealing, but showing all good faithfulness, so that in everything they may adorn the doctrine of God our Saviour. |
| 11 <i>For the grace of God that bringeth salvation hath appeared to all men,</i> | For the grace of God that brings salvation has appeared to all men, |
| 12 <i>Teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly, in this present world;</i> | teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present world, |
| 13 <i>Looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ;</i> | looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ — |

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Iniquity* (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin." Iniquity is not just a bad act — it is the corruption beneath the act, the bent nature that keeps producing evil. Christ redeems us from iniquity itself, not just from individual sins.

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| 14 <i>Who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works.</i> | who gave Himself for us, that He might redeem us from all iniquity and purify for Himself a peculiar people, zealous for good works. |
| 15 <i>These things speak, and exhort, and rebuke with all authority. Let no man despise thee.</i> | Speak these things, exhort, and rebuke with all authority. Let no one despise you. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Tim 1:13; 1 Tim 6:3; Titus 1:9; Titus 3:8; 1 Tim 1:10
- v2 — Gal 5:23; 1 Pet 4:7; 1 Tim 3:11; 1 Pet 5:8; 1 Thess 5:8
- v3 — Titus 2:4; 1 Tim 3:11; 1 Pet 3:3-5; 1 Tim 2:9-10; Titus 1:7
- v5 — Prov 31:10-31; Col 3:18; 1 Tim 5:10; 1 Pet 3:1-5; 1 Tim 5:13-14
- v6 — Eccl 12:1; 1 Pet 5:5; Eccl 11:9; Joel 2:28; 1 John 2:13
- v7 — 1 Pet 5:3; 1 Tim 4:12; 2 Cor 4:2; Phil 1:10; 2 Thess 3:9
- v8 — 1 Pet 2:12; 1 Pet 2:15; 1 Tim 6:3; 1 Pet 3:16; Phil 2:14-16
- v11 — Eph 2:8; 1 Tim 2:4; Isa 45:22; Heb 2:9; Eph 2:5
- v12 — Ezek 36:27; Matt 16:24; Rom 6:19; Ps 4:3; 2 Pet 2:9
- v13 — 2 Tim 4:8; 1 Cor 1:7; Matt 16:27; Titus 1:2; 2 Pet 3:12-14
- v14 — Heb 9:14; Eph 2:10; 1 Pet 2:9; 1 Pet 1:18; Titus 3:8
- v15 — 2 Tim 4:2; 1 Tim 4:12-13; Titus 1:13; 1 Tim 5:20; Matt 7:29

Chapter 3

Paul instructs Titus to remind believers to be subject to authorities, to be gentle, and to be ready for every good work. He declares that God saved us not by works of righteousness but according to His mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost, and warns Titus to avoid foolish questions, genealogies, and contentions about the law.

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| 1 | <i>Put them in mind to be subject to principalities and powers, to obey magistrates, to be ready to every good work,</i> | Remind them to be subject to rulers and authorities, to obey magistrates, to be ready for every good work, |
| 2 | <i>To speak evil of no man, to be no brawlers, but gentle, shewing all meekness unto all men.</i> | to speak evil of no one, to be peaceable, to be gentle, and to show all meekness to all men. |
| 3 | <i>For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving divers lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another.</i> | For we ourselves were once foolish, disobedient, deceived — slaves to all kinds of lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another. |
| 4 | <i>But after that the kindness and love of God our Saviour toward man appeared,</i> | But when the kindness and love of God our Saviour toward man appeared — |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Regeneration** (ree-jen-er-AY-shun) — *being born again; the new birth.* Regeneration is the moment God gives spiritual life to a dead soul. It is not self-improvement; it is resurrection. The Holy Ghost washes us clean and makes us new from the inside out.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity.* "Ghost" is the older English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is not a force or an influence — He is a person, fully God, who dwells in every believer and gives power for life and witness.

- | | |
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| <p>5 <i>Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost;</i></p> <p>6 <i>Which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour;</i></p> <p>7 <i>That being justified by his grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.</i></p> <p>8 <i>This is a faithful saying, and these things I will that thou affirm constantly, that they which have believed in God might be careful to maintain good works. These things are good and profitable unto men.</i></p> <p>9 <i>But avoid foolish questions, and genealogies, and contentions, and strivings about the law; for they are unprofitable and vain.</i></p> <p>10 <i>A man that is an heretick after the first and second admonition reject;</i></p> <p>11 <i>Knowing that he that is such is subverted, and sinneth, being condemned of himself.</i></p> | <p>not because of works of righteousness that we had done, but according to His mercy He saved us — by the washing of regeneration and the renewing of the Holy Ghost,</p> <p>whom He poured out on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour,</p> <p>so that, having been justified by His grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.</p> <p>This is a faithful saying. I want You to affirm these things firmly, so that those who have believed in God may be careful to devote themselves to good works. These things are good and profitable for all men.</p> <p>But avoid foolish controversies, genealogies, arguments, and quarrels about the law — for they are unprofitable and useless.</p> <p>Reject a man who is a heretic after the first and second warning,</p> <p>knowing that such a person is corrupted and sins, being self-condemned.</p> |
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- 12

When I shall send Artemas unto thee, or Tychicus, be diligent to come unto me to Nicopolis: for I have determined there to winter.
- When I send Artemas or Tychicus to you, do your best to come to me at Nicopolis, for I have decided to spend the winter there.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Artemas** (AR-teh-mas) — *A companion of Paul, otherwise unknown in Scripture; mentioned here as a possible replacement for Titus on Crete.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Tychicus** (TIK-ih-kus) — *A Christian from Asia (Acts 20:4); a regular bearer of Paul's letters (Eph 6:21; Col 4:7; 2 Tim 4:12), and possibly the carrier of this letter to Titus.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Nicopolis** (nih-KOP-oh-liss) — *"city of victory" — A city in Epirus (northwest Greece) where Paul planned to spend the winter.*

- 13

Bring Zenas the lawyer and Apollos on their journey diligently, that nothing be wanting unto them.
- Send Zenas the lawyer and Apollos on their way with diligence, so that they lack nothing.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Zenas** (ZEE-nas) — *"of Zeus" — A Christian lawyer (jurist) mentioned only here in Scripture.*

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Apollos** (uh-POL-os) — *The eloquent Alexandrian preacher; a major figure in 1 Corinthians and Acts 18. Priscilla and Aquila had taught him the way of God more accurately, and he became a powerful gospel laborer.*

- 14

And let ours also learn to maintain good works for necessary uses, that they be not unfruitful.
- And let our people also learn to devote themselves to good works to meet pressing needs, so that they will not be unfruitful.
- 15

All that are with me salute thee. Greet them that love us in the faith. Grace be with you all. Amen.
- All who are with me send You their greetings. Greet those who love us in the faith. Grace be with you all. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rom 13:1-7; 1 Pet 2:13-17; Eccl 10:4; Gal 6:9-10; Prov 24:21
- v2 — Eph 4:31; 2 Tim 2:24-25; Eph 4:2; Col 3:12-13; 1 Tim 3:3
- v3 — Eph 2:1-3; Col 1:21; Rom 6:17; Col 3:7; 1 Cor 6:9-11
- v4 — Eph 2:4-10; Titus 2:10-11; 1 Tim 4:10; Rom 5:20-21; Rom 2:4
- v5 — Eph 2:8-9; 2 Tim 1:9; 1 Cor 6:11; 1 Pet 1:3; 1 Pet 3:21

v6 — Joel 2:28; Rom 5:5; Acts 10:45

v7 — Rom 8:17; Titus 2:11; 1 Cor 6:11; Rom 3:24; Titus 1:2

v8 — Titus 3:14; Titus 2:14; Ps 16:2-3; Titus 1:9; Titus 3:1

v9 — 2 Tim 2:14; 2 Tim 2:23; 1 Tim 4:7; Titus 1:14; 2 Tim 2:16

v10 — Rom 16:17; 2 John 1:10; Matt 18:15-17; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Thess 3:14

v11 — Heb 10:26; Luke 19:22

v14 — Col 1:10; Titus 3:8; Phil 1:11; Matt 7:19; 2 Pet 1:8

Philemon

Author: Paul the apostle — he names himself in v1 and v19, where he says he writes the letter "with mine own hand" and personally guarantees Onesimus's debt.

Date written: c. AD 60–62, from Paul's first Roman imprisonment. It was carried alongside Colossians by the same messengers, Tychicus and Onesimus (Col 4:7–9).

Written to: Philemon, a wealthy Christian in Colossae who hosted a house church. The letter is also addressed to his wife Apphia, to Archippus (possibly his son), and to the church meeting in his home.

Setting: Onesimus, a runaway slave belonging to Philemon, had come to Paul in Rome. There Onesimus heard the gospel from Paul and was converted to Christ. Now Paul is sending him back — not in chains, but as a beloved brother — with this letter asking Philemon to receive him no longer as a slave but as a fellow heir of Christ. The whole letter is a single sustained appeal.

Where this sits historically: Written during Paul's first Roman imprisonment under Nero, in a Roman world where slaves made up perhaps a third of the empire's population and runaway slaves could legally be killed by their masters.

Contemporaries: Tychicus and Onesimus carried this letter alongside Colossians and Ephesians, and Paul's coworkers Epaphras, Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, and Luke were all with him in Rome.

Big themes:

- Christian brotherhood transcends every earthly division — the master-slave relationship is dissolved in Christ
- Substitutionary love — Paul offers to pay Onesimus's debt out of his own pocket, a small picture of what Christ has done for every sinner
- Pastoral persuasion over command — Paul has apostolic authority but chooses to appeal, not to order
- The transforming power of the gospel — Onesimus, whose name means "profitable," was once unprofitable to Philemon; the gospel has now made him truly useful
- Forgiveness and reconciliation — the central pastoral concern of the letter
- The dignity of persons in Christ — Onesimus, a slave by Roman law, is called "a brother beloved" by Paul

Key passages: Philemon 1:6; 1:10–11; 1:15–16; 1:17–19

How it fits: Philemon is the shortest of Paul's letters and the most personal. It is the only NT letter that deals with a single, specific pastoral problem between two named Christians. It demonstrates that the gospel does not preach social revolution from the outside — it dissolves earthly hierarchies from the inside by remaking persons. The letter is a small portrait of the larger doctrine of imputation: Paul says, in effect, "Whatever Onesimus owes, put on my

account." *That is the gospel in miniature.*

Chapter 1

Paul, writing as a prisoner, appeals to Philemon on behalf of his runaway slave Onesimus, who has become a believer under Paul's ministry. He asks Philemon to receive Onesimus no longer as a servant but as a beloved brother in Christ, and pledges to repay anything Onesimus owes.

- 1

Paul, a prisoner of Jesus Christ, and Timothy our brother, unto Philemon our dearly beloved, and fellowlabourer,

From Paul, a prisoner of Jesus Christ, and from Timothy our brother — to Philemon our dearly loved friend and fellow worker,
- 2

And to our beloved Apphia, and Archippus our fellowsoldier, and to the church in thy house:

and to our beloved Apphia, and to Archippus our fellow soldier, and to the church that meets in Your house:

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Philemon** (fih-LEE-mon) — "kissing, affectionate" — A wealthy Christian in Colossae who hosted a house church; the recipient of this letter and the owner of the runaway slave Onesimus.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Apphia** (AF-ee-ah) — "fruitful" — Almost certainly Philemon's wife; addressed alongside him in the opening greeting.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Archippus** (ar-KIP-us) — "horse-master" — Possibly Philemon's son, or a leader in the Colossian church; called Paul's "fellow soldier" here, and given a charge in Colossians 4:17.

- 3

Grace to you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Grace and peace to You from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never earn — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

- 4

I thank my God, making mention of thee always in my prayers,

I always thank my God whenever I mention You in my prayers,
- 5

Hearing of thy love and faith, which thou hast toward the Lord Jesus, and toward all saints;

because I keep hearing about Your love and Your faith — your faith toward the Lord Jesus, and Your love for all the saints.

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| <p>6 <i>That the communication of thy faith may become effectual by the acknowledging of every good thing which is in you in Christ Jesus.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For we have great joy and consolation in thy love, because the bowels of the saints are refreshed by thee, brother.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Wherefore, though I might be much bold in Christ to enjoin thee that which is convenient,</i></p> <p>9 <i>Yet for love's sake I rather beseech thee, being such an one as Paul the aged, and now also a prisoner of Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>10 <i>I beseech thee for my son Onesimus, whom I have begotten in my bonds:</i></p> | <p>I pray that the sharing of Your faith would become powerful through Your knowledge of every good thing that is in You for the sake of Christ Jesus.</p> <p>Your love has brought us great joy and comfort, brother, because the hearts of the saints have been refreshed by You.</p> <p>So then, although in Christ I could be very bold and simply order You to do what is right,</p> <p>yet for love's sake I would rather appeal to You. I am Paul — an old man now, and a prisoner of Jesus Christ as well —</p> <p>and I am appealing to You for my son Onesimus, whose father I became while I was in chains.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Onesimus** (oh-NES-ih-mus) — "profitable, useful" — A runaway slave belonging to Philemon, converted to Christ through Paul's ministry in Rome; Paul plays on the meaning of his name in v11. Paul is sending him back to Philemon with this letter. Early Christian tradition holds that Onesimus later became bishop of Ephesus.

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| <p>11 <i>Which in time past was to thee unprofitable, but now profitable to thee and to me:</i></p> <p>12 <i>Whom I have sent again: thou therefore receive him, that is, mine own bowels:</i></p> <p>13 <i>Whom I would have retained with me, that in thy stead he might have ministered unto me in the bonds of the gospel:</i></p> | <p>Once He was useless to You — but now He is truly useful, both to You and to me.</p> <p>I am sending Him back to You. Welcome Him — he is my very heart.</p> <p>I would have liked to keep Him here with me, so that in Your place He could serve me while I am in chains for the gospel.</p> |
|--|---|

- 14 *But without thy mind would I do nothing; that thy benefit should not be as it were of necessity, but willingly.* But I did not want to do anything without Your consent, so that whatever kindness You do would not be forced but would come from Your own free choice.
- 15 *For perhaps he therefore departed for a season, that thou shouldest receive him for ever;* Perhaps the reason He was separated from You for a little while was so that You might have Him back forever —
- 16 *Not now as a servant, but above a servant, a brother beloved, specially to me, but how much more unto thee, both in the flesh, and in the Lord?* no longer as a servant, but more than a servant — as a beloved brother. He is very dear to me, and how much more to You, both as a fellow man and as a brother in the Lord.
- 17 *If thou count me therefore a partner, receive him as myself.* So if You count me as a partner, welcome Him as You would welcome me.
- 18 *If he hath wronged thee, or oweth thee ought, put that on mine account;* And if He has wronged You in any way, or owes You anything, charge it to my account.
- 19 *I Paul have written it with mine own hand, I will repay it: albeit I do not say to thee how thou owest unto me even thine own self besides.* I, Paul, am writing this with my own hand: I will repay it. (Though I will not even mention that you owe me your very self.)
- 20 *Yea, brother, let me have joy of thee in the Lord: refresh my bowels in the Lord.* Yes, brother, let me have joy of you in the Lord; refresh my heart in the Lord.
- 21 *Having confidence in thy obedience I wrote unto thee, knowing that thou wilt also do more than I say.* Confident of your obedience, I write to you, knowing that you will do even more than I ask.
- 22 *But withal prepare me also a lodging: for I trust that through your prayers I shall be given unto you.* And one thing more — prepare a guest room for me; for I am trusting that through your prayers I will be given back to you.

23

There salute thee Epaphras, my
fellowprisoner in Christ Jesus;

Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in Christ
Jesus, sends You His greetings —

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Epaphras** (EP-ah-fras) — "lovely" — A native of Colossae, almost certainly the founder of the Colossian church (Col 1:7); a fellow prisoner with Paul in Rome; "always laboring fervently for you in prayers" (Col 4:12).

24

Marcus, Aristarchus, Demas, Lucas,
my fellowlabourers.

and so do Mark, Aristarchus, Demas,
and Luke — my fellow workers.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Mark** (also Marcus or John Mark) — Cousin of Barnabas; abandoned Paul on the first missionary journey (Acts 13:13; 15:37–38) but was later restored to usefulness in ministry (Col 4:10; 2 Tim 4:11); author of the Gospel of Mark.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Aristarchus** (air-iss-TAR-kus) — "best ruler" — A Macedonian from Thessalonica (Acts 19:29; 20:4); accompanied Paul on the voyage to Rome (Acts 27:2) and shared his imprisonment there.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Demas** (DEE-mas) — A companion of Paul during this imprisonment; later named in 2 Timothy 4:10 as one who forsook Paul, "having loved this present world." A solemn warning preserved in Scripture by name.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Luke** (also Lucas) — Greek physician (Col 4:14); the close traveling companion of Paul on much of his ministry, including the voyage to Rome; author of the Gospel of Luke and the book of Acts.

25

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with your spirit. Amen.

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with Your spirit. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — Col 1:1; Phlm 1:9; Eph 3:1; Phil 2:25
- v2 — Phil 2:25; Col 4:17; Rom 16:5
- v4 — Rom 1:8; Eph 1:16; Phil 1:3; Col 1:3
- v5 — Col 1:4; Eph 1:15
- v6 — 2 Pet 1:8; Phil 1:9-11; Col 1:9; 1 Pet 1:5-8; Matt 5:16
- v7 — 2 Cor 7:13; 1 Thess 3:9; 2 Cor 7:4; Phlm 1:20; 3 John 1:3-6
- v10 — Col 4:9; 1 Cor 4:15; 1 Tim 1:2; Gal 4:19; Titus 1:4
- v11 — 2 Tim 4:11; Job 30:1-2; Luke 15:32; 1 Pet 2:10
- v16 — Col 3:22; Matt 23:8; 1 Tim 6:2; 1 Cor 7:22
- v17 — 2 Cor 8:23; Matt 10:40
- v24 — Col 4:14; 2 Tim 4:10-11; Col 4:10
- v25 — 2 Tim 4:22; Rom 16:20; Gal 6:18

Hebrews

Author: Paul the apostle, traditionally — the KJV title ascribes it to Paul, and the early Eastern church consistently held Pauline authorship. The stylistic differences from Paul's other letters may reflect Luke's hand in translation from Aramaic or Paul's deliberate shift in register for a Jewish audience.

Date written: c. AD 64–68, before the destruction of the temple in AD 70 — the letter speaks of the Levitical sacrifices as ongoing.

Written to: Jewish Christians, likely in Palestine or Rome, who were under pressure to abandon Christianity and return to Judaism.

Setting: A community of Jewish believers is wavering. The temple still stands; the Levitical priesthood still functions; persecution is intensifying. The temptation to revert to the old covenant — with its visible sanctuary, hereditary priests, and ancestral prestige — is real. The author writes to demonstrate that Christ is better in every category.

Where this sits historically: Written under Nero in the final years before the Jewish revolt against Rome (AD 66–70), while the Jerusalem temple still stood and its daily sacrifices continued.

Contemporaries: Paul wrote his final letters (1–2 Timothy, Titus) and Peter wrote 1–2 Peter in the same window, while the church at Jerusalem awaited the storm that would soon scatter it.

Big themes:

- Christ is better — better than angels (chs. 1–2), better than Moses (ch. 3), better than Joshua (ch. 4), better than Aaron (chs. 5–7), better sanctuary (chs. 8–9), better sacrifice (ch. 10)
- The great High Priest — Hebrews develops the priesthood of Christ more thoroughly than any other NT book; He is a priest "after the order of Melchisedec," entering the true heavenly sanctuary with His own blood
- The new covenant — Jeremiah 31 is quoted twice (chs. 8, 10) to show that the old covenant was always preparatory; Christ has inaugurated the new covenant that Jeremiah promised
- Faith — chapter 11, the "hall of faith," defines faith as "the substance of things hoped for" and catalogs OT believers who acted on promises they did not receive in their lifetime
- Do not draw back — five solemn warning passages (2:1–4; 3:7–4:13; 5:11–6:12; 10:26–39; 12:25–29) urge the readers not to abandon Christ

Key passages: Heb 1:1–3; 4:12; 7:25; 9:22; 11:1; 12:1–2

How it fits: Hebrews is the NT's commentary on Leviticus. Without Leviticus, much of Hebrews is obscure; without Hebrews, the sacrificial system of Leviticus is incomplete. It is the bridge between OT ceremonial law and NT fulfillment, showing Christ as both the priest and the sacrifice who ended the whole system by completing it.

Chapter 1

The author argues that God, who spoke in times past through the prophets, has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, who is the brightness of His glory and the express image of His person. He demonstrates the Son's superiority over the angels by citing seven Old Testament passages proving that the Son is worshiped by angels and possesses an eternal throne.

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| 1 | <i>God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets,</i> | God, Who at sundry times and in divers manners spoke in time past to the fathers by the prophets, |
| 2 | <i>Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir of all things, by whom also he made the worlds;</i> | has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, whom He has appointed heir of all things, by whom also He made the worlds; |
| 3 | <i>Who being the brightness of his glory, and the express image of his person, and upholding all things by the word of his power, when he had by himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high;</i> | who being the brightness of His glory, and the express image of His person, and upholding all things by the word of His power, when He had by Himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high; |
| 4 | <i>Being made so much better than the angels, as he hath by inheritance obtained a more excellent name than they.</i> | being made so much better than the angels, as He has by inheritance obtained a more excellent name than they. |
| 5 | <i>For unto which of the angels said he at any time, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee? And again, I will be to him a Father, and he shall be to me a Son?</i> | For to which of the angels did He say at any time, "You are My Son, this day have I begotten You"? And again, "I will be to Him a Father, and He shall be to Me a Son"? |
| 6 | <i>And again, when he bringeth in the firstbegotten into the world, he saith, And let all the angels of God worship him.</i> | And again, when He brings in the firstbegotten into the world, He says, "And let all the angels of God worship Him." |
| 7 | <i>And of the angels he saith, Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire.</i> | And of the angels He says, "Who makes His angels spirits, and His ministers a flame of fire." |

- 8 *But unto the Son he saith, Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: a sceptre of righteousness is the sceptre of thy kingdom.* But to the Son He says, "Your throne, O God, is forever and ever; a scepter of righteousness is the scepter of Your kingdom."

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (in-*IK*-wih-tee) — deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. Where "sin" is missing the mark, iniquity is the bent nature that keeps pulling you away from God.

- 9 *Thou hast loved righteousness, and hated iniquity; therefore God, even thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.* You have loved righteousness, and hated iniquity; therefore God, even Your God, has anointed You with the oil of gladness above Your fellows."
- 10 *And, Thou, Lord, in the beginning hast laid the foundation of the earth; and the heavens are the works of thine hands:* And, "You, Lord, in the beginning have laid the foundation of the earth; and the heavens are the works of Your hands."
- 11 *They shall perish; but thou remainest; and they all shall wax old as doth a garment;* They shall perish; but You remain; and they all shall grow old as does a garment;
- 12 *And as a vesture shalt thou fold them up, and they shall be changed: but thou art the same, and thy years shall not fail.* and as a vesture shall You fold them up, and they shall be changed; but You are the same, and Your years shall not fail."
- 13 *But to which of the angels said he at any time, Sit on my right hand, until I make thine enemies thy footstool?* But to which of the angels did He say at any time, "Sit on My right hand, until I make Your enemies Your footstool"?
- 14 *Are they not all ministering spirits, sent forth to minister for them who shall be heirs of salvation?* Are they not all ministering spirits, sent forth to minister for those who shall be heirs of salvation?

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

sundry — Various; several different kinds — 'sundry times' in Hebrews 1:1 means 'many different ways and occasions.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Pet 1:20-21; Joel 2:28; Num 12:6-8; Luke 24:27; 1 Pet 1:10-12
- v2 — John 1:3; 1 Cor 8:6; Col 1:16-18; John 1:14; 1 Pet 1:20
- v3 — Col 1:15-17; Rev 4:11; John 14:9-10; John 1:14; 2 Cor 4:4
- v4 — Eph 1:21; Phil 2:9-11; 1 Pet 3:22; Heb 2:9; Rev 5:11-12
- v5 — Ps 2:7; Acts 13:33; Heb 5:5; 2 Sam 7:14; 1 Chr 17:13
- v6 — Ps 97:7; Col 1:18; 1 Pet 3:22; Deut 32:43; Col 1:15
- v7 — Ps 104:4; Heb 1:14; 2 Kgs 6:17; 2 Kgs 2:11; Ezek 1:13-14
- v8 — Ps 45:6-7; Isa 9:6-7; Jer 23:5-6; Rom 9:5; 1 John 5:20
- v9 — Ps 45:7; Ps 23:5; Isa 61:3; Gal 5:22; Rom 15:13
- v10 — Ps 102:25-27; Gen 1:1; John 1:1-3; Jer 32:17; Isa 48:13
- v13 — Ps 110:1; Mark 12:36; Matt 22:44; Heb 10:12-13; Acts 2:34-36
- v14 — Ps 34:7; Ps 103:20-21; Ps 91:11-12; Matt 18:10; Dan 6:22

Chapter 2

The author warns against neglecting so great a salvation and explains why Christ was made a little lower than the angels — to taste death for every man. He argues that because the children partake of flesh and blood, Christ also took part of the same, that through death He might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil, and deliver those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.

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| 1 | <i>Therefore we ought to give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard, lest at any time we should let them slip.</i> | Therefore we ought to give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard, lest at any time we should let them slip. |
| 2 | <i>For if the word spoken by angels was steadfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just recompence of reward;</i> | For if the word spoken by angels was steadfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just recompense of reward, |
| 3 | <i>How shall we escape, if we neglect so great salvation; which at the first began to be spoken by the Lord, and was confirmed unto us by them that heard him;</i> | how shall we escape, if we neglect so great salvation, which at the first began to be spoken by the Lord, and was confirmed to us by those who heard Him, |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. "Ghost" here is an older English word for "spirit." The Holy Ghost is fully God — not a force or feeling, but a divine Person who lives in believers and empowers them.*

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| <p>4 <i>God also bearing them witness, both with signs and wonders, and with divers miracles, and gifts of the Holy Ghost, according to his own will?</i></p> <p>5 <i>For unto the angels hath he not put in subjection the world to come, whereof we speak.</i></p> <p>6 <i>But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man, that thou art mindful of him? or the son of man, that thou visitest him?</i></p> <p>7 <i>Thou madest him a little lower than the angels; thou crownedst him with glory and honour, and didst set him over the works of thy hands:</i></p> <p>8 <i>Thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet. For in that he put all in subjection under him, he left nothing that is not put under him. But now we see not yet all things put under him.</i></p> | <p>God also bearing them witness, both with signs and wonders, and with divers miracles, and gifts of the Holy Ghost, according to His own will?</p> <p>For to the angels has He not put in subjection the world to come, of which we speak.</p> <p>But one in a certain place testified, saying, "What is man, that You are mindful of Him? Or the son of man, that You visit Him?</p> <p>You made Him a little lower than the angels; You crowned Him with glory and honor, and set Him over the works of Your hands;</p> <p>You have put all things in subjection under His feet." For in that He put all in subjection under Him, He left nothing that is not put under Him. But now we do not yet see all things put under Him.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not God overlooking sin — it is God paying the full price for sin Himself and then freely giving the benefit to those who trust Him.

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| <p>9 <i>But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour; that he by the grace of God should taste death for every man.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For it became him, for whom are all things, and by whom are all things, in bringing many sons unto glory, to make the captain of their salvation perfect through sufferings.</i></p> | <p>But we see Jesus, Who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honor, that He by the grace of God should taste death for every man.</p> <p>For it became Him, for whom are all things, and by whom are all things, in bringing many sons to glory, to make the captain of their salvation perfect through sufferings.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctification** (SANK-tih-fih-KAY-shun) — *being made holy; the lifelong process of being set apart for God. At the moment of salvation God declares you holy (justification); then He spends your whole life actually making you holy (sanctification). Both the one who sanctifies and those being sanctified share the same Father.*

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| <p>11 <i>For both he that sanctifieth and they who are sanctified are all of one: for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren,</i></p> <p>12 <i>Saying, I will declare thy name unto my brethren, in the midst of the church will I sing praise unto thee.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And again, I will put my trust in him. And again, Behold I and the children which God hath given me.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, he also himself likewise took part of the same; that through death he might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil;</i></p> <p>15 <i>And deliver them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For verily he took not on him the nature of angels; but he took on him the seed of Abraham.</i></p> | <p>For both He who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all of one; for which cause He is not ashamed to call them brethren,</p> <p>saying, "I will declare Your name to My brethren; in the midst of the church will I sing praise to You."</p> <p>And again, "I will put My trust in Him." And again, "Here am I and the children which God has given Me."</p> <p>Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, He also Himself likewise took part of the same, that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil,</p> <p>and deliver those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.</p> <p>For truly He took not on Him the nature of angels, but He took on Him the seed of Abraham.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Atonement** (uh-TONE-ment) — *the payment for sin that brings God and man back together. The word literally contains "at-one-ment" — the making of two parties into one. Christ's atonement satisfied God's just anger against sin and restored the broken relationship between God and humanity.*

17	<i>Wherefore in all things it behoved him to be made like unto his brethren, that he might be a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God, to make reconciliation for the sins of the people.</i>	Therefore in all things it behooved Him to be made like His brethren, that He might be a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God, to make reconciliation for the sins of the people.
18	<i>For in that he himself hath suffered being tempted, he is able to succour them that are tempted.</i>	For in that He Himself has suffered being tempted, He is able to succor those who are tempted.

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 8:15; 2 Pet 1:12-13; Prov 7:1-2; Deut 4:9; Prov 2:1-6
- v2 — Acts 7:53; Gal 3:19; Heb 10:28; Jude 1:5; Deut 27:26
- v3 — Heb 10:28-29; Heb 12:25; Heb 5:9; Acts 4:12; 1 Pet 4:17-18
- v6 — Ps 8:4-8; Ps 144:3; Job 7:17-18; Isa 51:12
- v8 — John 13:3; 1 Cor 15:27; Ps 8:6; 1 Pet 3:22; Dan 7:14
- v9 — Phil 2:7-9; Rev 5:9; 1 John 4:9-10; Rom 5:18; 1 John 2:2
- v11 — Rom 8:29; Heb 10:10; Heb 13:12; Heb 10:14; John 20:17
- v13 — Isa 8:17-18; Isa 12:2; Ps 91:2; Gen 48:9; John 10:29
- v14 — 2 Tim 1:10; Rom 8:3; Col 2:15; 1 Cor 15:54-57; John 1:14
- v15 — Rom 8:15; 2 Tim 1:7; Luke 1:74-75; Rom 8:21; Ps 55:4
- v17 — Phil 2:7-8; Heb 4:14-5:2; Heb 2:14; Rom 5:10; Heb 7:26
- v18 — 1 Cor 10:13; Heb 4:15-16; Jude 1:24; Heb 7:25-26; Heb 5:2

Chapter 3

The author argues that Christ is worthy of more glory than Moses, as the builder of the house has more honour than the house itself. He warns against hardening the heart as Israel did in the wilderness, quoting Psalm 95, and urges believers to exhort one another daily lest any be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin.

1	<i>Wherefore, holy brethren, partakers of the heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our profession, Christ Jesus;</i>	Therefore, holy brethren, partakers of the heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our profession, Christ Jesus,
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| <p>2 <i>Who was faithful to him that appointed him, as also Moses was faithful in all his house.</i></p> <p>3 <i>For this man was counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as he who hath builded the house hath more honour than the house.</i></p> <p>4 <i>For every house is builded by some man; but he that built all things is God.</i></p> <p>5 <i>And Moses verily was faithful in all his house, as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken after;</i></p> <p>6 <i>But Christ as a son over his own house; whose house are we, if we hold fast the confidence and the rejoicing of the hope firm unto the end.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice,</i></p> <p>8 <i>Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness:</i></p> <p>9 <i>When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my works forty years.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Wherefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, They do alway err in their heart; and they have not known my ways.</i></p> <p>11 <i>So I swear in my wrath, They shall not enter into my rest.)</i></p> | <p>who was faithful to Him who appointed Him, as also Moses was faithful in all his house.</p> <p>For this man was counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as he who has built the house has more honor than the house.</p> <p>For every house is built by some man, but He who built all things is God.</p> <p>And Moses truly was faithful in all his house, as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken after;</p> <p>but Christ as a son over His own house; whose house we are, if we hold fast the confidence and the rejoicing of the hope firm to the end.</p> <p>Therefore (as the Holy Ghost says, "Today if You will hear His voice, harden not Your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness, when Your fathers tempted Me, proved Me, and saw My works forty years.</p> <p>Therefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, 'They do always err in their heart; and they have not known My ways.'</p> <p>So I swear in My wrath, 'They shall not enter into My rest.'")</p> |
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| <p>12 <i>Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief, in departing from the living God.</i></p> <p>13 <i>But exhort one another daily, while it is called To day; lest any of you be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For we are made partakers of Christ, if we hold the beginning of our confidence stedfast unto the end;</i></p> <p>15 <i>While it is said, To day if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts, as in the provocation.</i></p> <p>16 <i>For some, when they had heard, did provoke: howbeit not all that came out of Egypt by Moses.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But with whom was he grieved forty years? was it not with them that had sinned, whose carcasses fell in the wilderness?</i></p> <p>18 <i>And to whom sware he that they should not enter into his rest, but to them that believed not?</i></p> <p>19 <i>So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.</i></p> | <p>Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of You an evil heart of unbelief, in departing from the living God.</p> <p>But exhort one another daily, while it is called "Today," lest any of You be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin.</p> <p>For we are made partakers of Christ, if we hold the beginning of our confidence steadfast to the end,</p> <p>while it is said, "Today if You will hear His voice, harden not Your hearts, as in the provocation."</p> <p>For some, when they had heard, did provoke; however, not all who came out of Egypt by Moses.</p> <p>But with whom was He grieved forty years? Was it not with those who had sinned, whose carcasses fell in the wilderness?</p> <p>And to whom did He swear that they should not enter into His rest, but to those who believed not?</p> <p>So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — 2 Tim 1:9; Phil 3:14; Heb 4:14-15; 1 Pet 2:9; Heb 7:26
v3 — 1 Cor 3:9; 1 Pet 2:5-7; Zech 6:12-13; Heb 2:9
v5 — Num 12:7; Heb 3:2; Ex 14:31; Acts 28:23; Ps 105:26
v6 — 2 Cor 6:16; 1 Cor 3:16; Heb 10:35; 1 Cor 6:19; Heb 6:11
v7 — Ps 95:7-11; Heb 3:15; Isa 55:3; Rev 3:20; Heb 4:7

v8 — Prov 28:14; Ex 17:7; Zech 7:11-12; Matt 13:15; Jer 7:26

v12 — Jer 17:5; Jer 7:24; Jer 17:9; Jer 18:12; 1 Cor 10:12

v13 — 1 Thess 5:11; Heb 10:24-25; 2 Tim 4:2; 1 Thess 4:18; Jas 1:14

v14 — Heb 3:6; Heb 6:11; Heb 12:10; 1 Pet 4:13; Eph 3:6

v15 — Heb 3:7-8; Ps 95:7; Heb 10:38; Heb 10:29

v17 — Num 14:29; Num 14:22; Num 26:64-65; Num 14:32-33; Jude 1:5

v18 — Heb 4:6; Deut 1:34-35; Num 14:30; Ps 106:24-26; Deut 1:26-32

Chapter 4

The author urges believers to fear lest they fail to enter God's rest, as Israel failed through unbelief, and declares that there remains therefore a rest for the people of God. He declares that the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword, and exhorts believers to come boldly unto the throne of grace, since we have a great high priest, Jesus the Son of God, who can be touched with the feeling of our infirmities.

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| <p>1 <i>Let us therefore fear, lest, a promise being left us of entering into his rest, any of you should seem to come short of it.</i></p> | <p>Let us therefore fear, lest, a promise being left us of entering into His rest, any of You should seem to come short of it.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For unto us was the gospel preached, as well as unto them: but the word preached did not profit them, not being mixed with faith in them that heard it.</i></p> | <p>For to us was the gospel preached, as well as to them; but the word preached did not profit them, not being mixed with faith in those who heard it.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For we which have believed do enter into rest, as he said, As I have sworn in my wrath, if they shall enter into my rest: although the works were finished from the foundation of the world.</i></p> | <p>For we who have believed do enter into rest, as He said, "As I have sworn in My wrath, if they shall enter into My rest"; although the works were finished from the foundation of the world.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For he spake in a certain place of the seventh day on this wise, And God did rest the seventh day from all his works.</i></p> | <p>For He spoke in a certain place of the seventh day in this way, "And God did rest the seventh day from all His works."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And in this place again, If they shall enter into my rest.</i></p> | <p>And in this place again, "If they shall enter into My rest."</p> |

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| 6 | <i>Seeing therefore it remaineth that some must enter therein, and they to whom it was first preached entered not in because of unbelief:</i> | Seeing therefore it remains that some must enter into it, and those to whom it was first preached entered not in because of unbelief, |
| 7 | <i>Again, he limiteth a certain day, saying in David, To day, after so long a time; as it is said, To day if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts.</i> | again, He limits a certain day, saying in David, "Today," after so long a time, as it is said, "Today if you will hear His voice, harden not your hearts." |
| 8 | <i>For if Jesus had given them rest, then would he not afterward have spoken of another day.</i> | For if Jesus had given them rest, then would He not afterward have spoken of another day. |
| 9 | <i>There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God.</i> | There remains therefore a rest to the people of God. |
| 10 | <i>For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his.</i> | For He who has entered into his rest, he also has ceased from His own works, as God did from His. |
| 11 | <i>Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.</i> | Let us labor therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief. |
| 12 | <i>For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.</i> | For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart. |
| 13 | <i>Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of him with whom we have to do.</i> | Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in His sight; but all things are naked and opened to the eyes of Him with whom we have to do. |

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| <p>14 <i>Seeing then that we have a great high priest, that is passed into the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our profession.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin.</i></p> | <p>Seeing then that we have a great high priest, who is passed into the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our profession.</p> <p>For we have not a high priest who cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Mercy* (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. *Mercy* is not ignoring sin — it is the sovereign choice of God to spare the guilty. At the throne of grace we find both mercy (not getting what we deserve) and grace (getting what we don't deserve).

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| <p>16 <i>Let us therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need.</i></p> | <p>Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sabbath (SAB-ath) — The seventh day of the week, set apart for rest and worship — instituted at creation; Israel was commanded to do no work on this day.

Joshua (JOSH-oo-ah) — Moses's successor who led Israel into Canaan — his name means 'the LORD saves'; the same Hebrew name as Jesus.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 12:15; Heb 4:9; Prov 28:14; 1 Cor 9:26-27; Heb 4:11
- v2 — 1 Thess 2:13; Rom 10:16-17; Heb 11:6; Heb 3:18-19
- v3 — Ps 95:11; Matt 11:28-29; 1 Pet 1:20; Eph 1:4; Gen 1:31
- v7 — Ps 95:7; Heb 3:7-8; Heb 3:15
- v9 — 1 Pet 2:10; Rev 21:4; Rev 7:14-17; Isa 11:10; Heb 3:11
- v10 — Rev 14:13; Heb 4:3-4; 1 Pet 4:1-2; John 19:30; Heb 10:12
- v11 — Matt 11:28-30; Luke 13:24; Heb 3:18-4:1; Eph 5:6; Heb 6:11
- v12 — Jer 23:29; Isa 55:11; Eph 6:17; Ps 119:130; 1 Pet 1:23
- v13 — 1 Cor 4:5; Ps 33:13-15; Prov 15:3; Eccl 12:14; 1 Sam 16:7
- v14 — Heb 9:24; Heb 12:2; Heb 9:12; Heb 10:23; Heb 6:20
- v15 — Heb 2:17-18; 2 Cor 5:21; Isa 53:4-5; 1 John 3:5; 1 Pet 2:22
- v16 — Eph 3:12; Heb 7:25; Heb 10:19-23; Heb 13:6; Phil 4:6-7

Chapter 5

The author explains the role of the high priest, showing that Christ did not glorify Himself but was called by God, a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec. He rebukes the readers for being dull of hearing, still needing milk rather than strong meat, when by this time they ought to be teachers.

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| 1 | <i>For every high priest taken from among men is ordained for men in things pertaining to God, that he may offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins:</i> | For every high priest taken from among men is ordained for men in things pertaining to God, that He may offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins, |
| 2 | <i>Who can have compassion on the ignorant, and on them that are out of the way; for that he himself also is compassed with infirmity.</i> | who can have compassion on the ignorant, and on those who are out of the way; for He Himself also is compassed with infirmity. |
| 3 | <i>And by reason hereof he ought, as for the people, so also for himself, to offer for sins.</i> | And by reason of this He ought, as for the people, so also for himself, to offer for sins. |
| 4 | <i>And no man taketh this honour unto himself, but he that is called of God, as was Aaron.</i> | And no man takes this honor to himself, but he who is called of God, as was Aaron. |
| 5 | <i>So also Christ glorified not himself to be made an high priest; but he that said unto him, Thou art my Son, to day have I begotten thee.</i> | So also Christ glorified not Himself to be made a high priest; but He who said to him, "You are My Son, today have I begotten You." |
| 6 | <i>As he saith also in another place, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.</i> | As He says also in another place, "You are a priest forever after the order of Melchisedec." |
| 7 | <i>Who in the days of his flesh, when he had offered up prayers and supplications with strong crying and tears unto him that was able to save him from death, and was heard in that he feared;</i> | Who in the days of His flesh, when He had offered up prayers and supplications with strong crying and tears to Him who was able to save Him from death, and was heard in that He feared, |
| 8 | <i>Though he were a Son, yet learned he obedience by the things which he suffered;</i> | though He were a Son, yet learned He obedience by the things which He suffered; |

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| <p>9 <i>And being made perfect, he became the author of eternal salvation unto all them that obey him;</i></p> <p>10 <i>Called of God an high priest after the order of Melchisedec.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Of whom we have many things to say, and hard to be uttered, seeing ye are dull of hearing.</i></p> <p>12 <i>For when for the time ye ought to be teachers, ye have need that one teach you again which be the first principles of the oracles of God; and are become such as have need of milk, and not of strong meat.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For every one that useth milk is unskilful in the word of righteousness: for he is a babe.</i></p> <p>14 <i>But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age, even those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.</i></p> | <p>and being made perfect, He became the author of eternal salvation to all those who obey Him,</p> <p>called of God a high priest after the order of Melchisedec.</p> <p>Of whom we have many things to say, and hard to be uttered, seeing You are dull of hearing.</p> <p>For when by this time You ought to be teachers, You have need that one teach You again which be the first principles of the oracles of God; and have become such as have need of milk, and not of strong meat.</p> <p>For every one who uses milk is unskillful in the word of righteousness, for He is a babe.</p> <p>But strong meat belongs to those who are of full age, even those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

meat — Food in general — in the KJV, 'meat' often means any food, not specifically flesh; 'meat offering' is a grain offering.

Aaron (*AIR-on*) — Moses's older brother and Israel's first high priest — spokesperson for Moses before Pharaoh; his descendants served as priests throughout Israel's history.

Cross-References:

v1 — Heb 8:3; Heb 10:11; Heb 7:27; Heb 2:17; Heb 9:9

v2 — Heb 4:15; Heb 2:18; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Heb 7:28

v4 — Ex 28:1; Num 16:5; Num 16:40; 2 Chr 26:18; 1 Chr 23:13

v5 — Ps 2:7; John 8:54; John 7:18; Acts 13:33; Heb 1:5

v6 — Ps 110:4; Heb 7:17; Heb 7:21; Heb 7:3; Gen 14:18-19

v7 — Luke 22:41-44; Mark 14:32-39; John 17:1; Matt 27:46; John 17:4-5

v8 — Phil 2:8; Heb 10:5-9; John 4:34; Isa 50:5-6; John 15:10

- v9 — Heb 9:12; Heb 2:10; Heb 9:15; Heb 12:2; Acts 5:32
- v11 — Matt 13:15; Acts 28:27; 2 Pet 3:16; John 16:12
- v12 — Heb 6:1; 1 Cor 3:1-3; 1 Pet 2:2; Heb 5:13; Isa 28:9-10
- v13 — 1 Pet 2:2; 1 Cor 14:20; 2 Tim 3:16; Eph 4:14; Isa 28:9
- v14 — 1 Cor 2:14-15; 1 Thess 5:21; Phil 1:9-10; Isa 7:15; 1 Cor 2:6

Chapter 6

The author urges believers to press on to maturity and delivers a solemn warning that it is impossible for those who were once enlightened, if they fall away, to be renewed again unto repentance. He assures them that God is not unrighteous to forget their work and labour of love, and points to the sure and steadfast anchor of God's oath and promise.

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| 1 | <i>Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ, let us go on unto perfection; not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith toward God,</i> | Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ, let us go on to perfection, not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith toward God, |
| 2 | <i>Of the doctrine of baptisms, and of laying on of hands, and of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment.</i> | of the doctrine of baptisms, and of laying on of hands, and of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment. |
| 3 | <i>And this will we do, if God permit.</i> | And this we will do, if God permit. |
| 4 | <i>For it is impossible for those who were once enlightened, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost,</i> | For it is impossible for those who were once enlightened, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost, |
| 5 | <i>And have tasted the good word of God, and the powers of the world to come,</i> | and have tasted the good word of God, and the powers of the world to come, |
| 6 | <i>If they shall fall away, to renew them again unto repentance; seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God afresh, and put him to an open shame.</i> | if they shall fall away, to renew them again to repentance; seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God afresh, and put Him to an open shame. |

- 7 *For the earth which drinketh in the rain that cometh oft upon it, and bringeth forth herbs meet for them by whom it is dressed, receiveth blessing from God:* For the earth which drinks in the rain that comes often on it, and brings forth herbs fit for those by whom it is dressed, receives blessing from God;
- 8 *But that which beareth thorns and briers is rejected, and is nigh unto cursing; whose end is to be burned.* but that which bears thorns and briers is rejected, and is near to cursing; whose end is to be burned.
- 9 *But, beloved, we are persuaded better things of you, and things that accompany salvation, though we thus speak.* But, beloved, we are persuaded better things of You, and things that accompany salvation, though we thus speak.
- 10 *For God is not unrighteous to forget your work and labour of love, which ye have shewed toward his name, in that ye have ministered to the saints, and do minister.* For God is not unrighteous to forget Your work and labor of love, which You have shown toward His name, in that You have ministered to the saints, and do minister.
- 11 *And we desire that every one of you do shew the same diligence to the full assurance of hope unto the end:* And we desire that every one of you do show the same diligence to the full assurance of hope to the end,
- 12 *That ye be not slothful, but followers of them who through faith and patience inherit the promises.* that You be not slothful, but followers of those who through faith and patience inherit the promises.
- 13 *For when God made promise to Abraham, because he could swear by no greater, he sware by himself,* For when God made promise to Abraham, because he could swear by no greater, he swore by Himself,
- 14 *Saying, Surely blessing I will bless thee, and multiplying I will multiply thee.* saying, "Surely blessing I will bless you, and multiplying I will multiply you."
- 15 *And so, after he had patiently endured, he obtained the promise.* And so, after he had patiently endured, he obtained the promise.
- 16 *For men verily swear by the greater: and an oath for confirmation is to them an end of all strife.* For men truly swear by the greater, and an oath for confirmation is to them an end of all strife.

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| <p>17 <i>Wherein God, willing more abundantly to shew unto the heirs of promise the immutability of his counsel, confirmed it by an oath:</i></p> <p>18 <i>That by two immutable things, in which it was impossible for God to lie, we might have a strong consolation, who have fled for refuge to lay hold upon the hope set before us:</i></p> <p>19 <i>Which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and stedfast, and which entereth into that within the veil;</i></p> <p>20 <i>Whither the forerunner is for us entered, even Jesus, made an high priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.</i></p> | <p>Wherein God, willing more abundantly to show to the heirs of promise the immutability of His counsel, confirmed it by an oath,</p> <p>that by two immutable things, in which it was impossible for God to lie, we might have a strong consolation, who have fled for refuge to lay hold on the hope set before us;</p> <p>which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and steadfast, and which enters into that within the veil,</p> <p>where the forerunner is entered for us, even Jesus, made a high priest forever after the order of Melchisedec.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

sanctuary — The holy place — the sacred space set apart for God's presence; the inner section of the tabernacle or temple.

Cross-References:

v1 — Heb 5:12-14; Heb 9:14; 2 Cor 7:1; Acts 26:20; Heb 12:13
v4 — Heb 10:26-29; 2 Pet 2:20-22; Matt 5:13; John 15:6; Matt 7:21-22
v6 — 2 Pet 2:21; Heb 10:29; Heb 6:4; 1 John 5:16; Isa 1:28
v7 — Hos 10:12; Isa 44:3; Ps 65:9-13; Isa 55:10-13; Joel 2:21-26
v10 — Heb 13:16; Matt 10:42; Gal 6:10; 1 Thess 1:3; Acts 10:4
v11 — 2 Pet 1:5-8; Rom 5:2-5; Heb 3:6; Heb 3:14; 2 Pet 1:10
v12 — Heb 13:7; Heb 10:36; Rom 12:11; 1 John 2:25; Jer 6:16
v13 — Gen 22:15-18; Luke 1:73; Ps 105:9-10; Mic 7:20; Isa 45:23
v14 — Gen 22:17; Deut 1:10; Neh 9:23; Gen 17:2; Ex 32:13
v17 — Prov 19:21; Heb 6:18; Isa 55:11; Isa 14:24; Heb 11:9
v18 — Num 23:19; Titus 1:2; 1 Sam 15:29; 2 Tim 2:13; Rom 3:4
v19 — Rom 5:5-10; Ps 43:5; Rom 8:28-39; Heb 9:7; Lev 16:15

Chapter 7

The author argues that Melchisedec — king of Salem, priest of the most high God — was greater than Abraham, since Abraham paid tithes to him. He demonstrates that Christ's priesthood after the order of Melchisedec is superior to the Levitical priesthood, because He continues for ever with an unchangeable priesthood and is able to save them to the uttermost that come unto God by Him.

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| <p>1 <i>For this Melchisedec, king of Salem, priest of the most high God, who met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings, and blessed him;</i></p> | <p>For this Melchisedec, king of Salem, priest of the most high God, Who met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings, and blessed him;</p> |
| <p>2 <i>To whom also Abraham gave a tenth part of all; first being by interpretation King of righteousness, and after that also King of Salem, which is, King of peace;</i></p> | <p>to whom also Abraham gave a tenth part of all; first being by interpretation King of righteousness, and after that also King of Salem, which is, King of peace;</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Without father, without mother, without descent, having neither beginning of days, nor end of life; but made like unto the Son of God; abideth a priest continually.</i></p> | <p>without father, without mother, without descent, having neither beginning of days, nor end of life; but made like to the Son of God, abides a priest continually.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Now consider how great this man was, unto whom even the patriarch Abraham gave the tenth of the spoils.</i></p> | <p>Now consider how great this man was, to whom even the patriarch Abraham gave the tenth of the spoils.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And verily they that are of the sons of Levi, who receive the office of the priesthood, have a commandment to take tithes of the people according to the law, that is, of their brethren, though they come out of the loins of Abraham:</i></p> | <p>And truly those who are of the sons of Levi, who receive the office of the priesthood, have a commandment to take tithes of the people according to the law, that is, of their brethren, though they come out of the loins of Abraham;</p> |
| <p>6 <i>But he whose descent is not counted from them received tithes of Abraham, and blessed him that had the promises.</i></p> | <p>but he whose descent is not counted from them received tithes from Abraham, and blessed him who had the promises.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And without all contradiction the less is blessed of the better.</i></p> | <p>And without all contradiction the less is blessed by the better.</p> |

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| <p>8 <i>And here men that die receive tithes; but there he receiveth them, of whom it is witnessed that he liveth.</i></p> <p>9 <i>And as I may so say, Levi also, who receiveth tithes, payed tithes in Abraham.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For he was yet in the loins of his father, when Melchisedec met him.</i></p> <p>11 <i>If therefore perfection were by the Levitical priesthood, (for under it the people received the law,) what further need was there that another priest should rise after the order of Melchisedec, and not be called after the order of Aaron?</i></p> <p>12 <i>For the priesthood being changed, there is made of necessity a change also of the law.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For he of whom these things are spoken pertaineth to another tribe, of which no man gave attendance at the altar.</i></p> <p>14 <i>For it is evident that our Lord sprang out of Juda; of which tribe Moses spake nothing concerning priesthood.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And it is yet far more evident: for that after the similitude of Melchisedec there ariseth another priest,</i></p> <p>16 <i>Who is made, not after the law of a carnal commandment, but after the power of an endless life.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For he testifieth, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.</i></p> | <p>And here men who die receive tithes; but there he receives them, of whom it is witnessed that he lives.</p> <p>And, so to speak, Levi also, who receives tithes, paid tithes in Abraham.</p> <p>For he was yet in the loins of his father, when Melchisedec met him.</p> <p>If therefore perfection were by the Levitical priesthood (for under it the people received the law), what further need was there that another priest should rise after the order of Melchisedec, and not be called after the order of Aaron?</p> <p>For the priesthood being changed, there is made of necessity a change also of the law.</p> <p>For He of whom these things are spoken pertains to another tribe, of which no man gave attendance at the altar.</p> <p>For it is evident that our Lord sprang out of Juda, of which tribe Moses spoke nothing concerning priesthood.</p> <p>And it is yet far more evident, for that after the similitude of Melchisedec there arises another priest,</p> <p>who is made, not after the law of a carnal commandment, but after the power of an endless life.</p> <p>For He testifies, "You are a priest forever after the order of Melchisedec."</p> |
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| <p>18 <i>For there is verily a disannulling of the commandment going before for the weakness and unprofitableness thereof.</i></p> <p>19 <i>For the law made nothing perfect, but the bringing in of a better hope did; by the which we draw nigh unto God.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And inasmuch as not without an oath he was made priest:</i></p> <p>21 <i>(For those priests were made without an oath; but this with an oath by him that said unto him, The Lord sware and will not repent, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec:)</i></p> | <p>For there is truly a disannulling of the commandment going before for the weakness and unprofitableness thereof.</p> <p>For the law made nothing perfect, but the bringing in of a better hope did, by which we draw near to God.</p> <p>And inasmuch as not without an oath He was made priest</p> <p>(for those priests were made without an oath; but this with an oath by Him who said to Him, "The Lord sware and will not repent, You are a priest forever after the order of Melchisedec"),</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Covenant** (KUV-uh-nunt) — a binding agreement; God's solemn promise that establishes the relationship between Him and His people. Unlike a contract between equals, God's covenants are initiated by Him, guaranteed by Him, and sealed in blood. The new covenant sealed by Christ's blood is better than every covenant that came before it.

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| <p>22 <i>By so much was Jesus made a surety of a better testament.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And they truly were many priests, because they were not suffered to continue by reason of death:</i></p> <p>24 <i>But this man, because he continueth ever, hath an unchangeable priesthood.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Wherefore he is able also to save them to the uttermost that come unto God by him, seeing he ever liveth to make intercession for them.</i></p> | <p>By so much was Jesus made a surety of a better testament.</p> <p>And they truly were many priests, because they were not allowed to continue by reason of death;</p> <p>but this man, because he continues ever, has an unchangeable priesthood.</p> <p>Therefore He is able also to save to the uttermost those who come to God by Him, seeing He ever lives to make intercession for them.</p> |
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| <p>26 <i>For such an high priest became us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and made higher than the heavens;</i></p> <p>27 <i>Who needeth not daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifice, first for his own sins, and then for the people's: for this he did once, when he offered up himself.</i></p> <p>28 <i>For the law maketh men high priests which have infirmity; but the word of the oath, which was since the law, maketh the Son, who is consecrated for evermore.</i></p> | <p>For such a high priest became us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and made higher than the heavens;</p> <p>who needs not daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifice, first for his own sins, and then for the people's; for this he did once, when he offered up Himself.</p> <p>For the law makes men high priests who have infirmity; but the word of the oath, which was since the law, makes the Son, who is consecrated forevermore.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Cross-References:

v1 — Gen 14:18-20; Ps 57:2; Heb 6:20; Mic 6:6; Gen 16:14-16

v8 — Heb 6:20; Heb 5:6; Rev 1:18; John 14:19; Heb 7:23

v14 — Mic 5:2; Isa 11:1; Rev 5:5; Luke 3:33

v17 — Ps 110:4; Heb 5:6; Heb 7:21; Heb 7:15

v18 — Rom 8:3; Acts 13:39; Heb 7:11-12; Gal 4:9; Heb 8:7-13

v19 — Acts 13:39; Heb 4:16; Heb 9:9; Rom 8:3

v21 — Ps 110:4; Heb 7:17

v22 — 1 Cor 11:25; Heb 8:6-12; Heb 9:15-23; Luke 22:20; Gen 44:32

v25 — Rom 8:34; 1 John 2:1-2; 1 Tim 2:5; Jude 1:24; John 14:6

v26 — 2 Cor 5:21; 1 Pet 2:22; Heb 4:14-15; 1 John 2:2; Heb 8:1

v27 — Heb 9:28; Heb 9:12; Heb 9:14; Eph 5:2; Heb 10:6-12

v28 — Heb 2:10; Heb 1:2; Heb 7:21; Heb 5:1-2

Chapter 8

The author declares that we have a high priest who is seated at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens, a minister of the true tabernacle which the Lord pitched and not man. He argues that Christ is the mediator of a better covenant established on better promises, quoting Jeremiah's prophecy of the new covenant in which God writes His laws on the heart.

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| <p>1 <i>Now of the things which we have spoken this is the sum: We have such an high priest, who is set on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens;</i></p> | <p>Now of the things which we have spoken this is the sum: We have such a high priest, who is set on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens,</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Tabernacle** (TAB-er-na-kul) — *the tent of meeting; Israel's portable worship structure where God's presence dwelt among His people in the wilderness. Everything about the tabernacle — its layout, its furniture, its sacrifices — was designed by God as a shadow picture of Christ and the true heavenly sanctuary.*

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| <p>2 <i>A minister of the sanctuary, and of the true tabernacle, which the Lord pitched, and not man.</i></p> | <p>a minister of the sanctuary, and of the true tabernacle, which the Lord pitched, and not man.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For every high priest is ordained to offer gifts and sacrifices: wherefore it is of necessity that this man have somewhat also to offer.</i></p> | <p>For every high priest is ordained to offer gifts and sacrifices; therefore it is of necessity that this man have something also to offer.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For if he were on earth, he should not be a priest, seeing that there are priests that offer gifts according to the law:</i></p> | <p>For if He were on earth, He should not be a priest, seeing that there are priests who offer gifts according to the law,</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Who serve unto the example and shadow of heavenly things, as Moses was admonished of God when he was about to make the tabernacle: for, See, saith he, that thou make all things according to the pattern shewed to thee in the mount.</i></p> | <p>who serve to the example and shadow of heavenly things, as Moses was admonished of God when He was about to make the tabernacle; for "See," says He, "that you make all things according to the pattern shown to you in the mount."</p> |

- 6 *But now hath he obtained a more excellent ministry, by how much also he is the mediator of a better covenant, which was established upon better promises.* But now He has obtained a more excellent ministry, by how much also He is the mediator of a better covenant, which was established on better promises.
- 7 *For if that first covenant had been faultless, then should no place have been sought for the second.* For if that first covenant had been faultless, then no place should have been sought for the second.
- 8 *For finding fault with them, he saith, Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah:* For finding fault with them, He says, "The days come, says the Lord, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah,
- 9 *Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day when I took them by the hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt; because they continued not in my covenant, and I regarded them not, saith the Lord.* not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day when I took them by the hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt; because they continued not in My covenant, and I regarded them not, says the Lord.
- 10 *For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, saith the Lord; I will put my laws into their mind, and write them in their hearts: and I will be to them a God, and they shall be to me a people:* For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, says the Lord: I will put My laws into their mind, and write them in their hearts; and I will be to them a God, and they shall be to Me a people.
- 11 *And they shall not teach every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying, Know the Lord: for all shall know me, from the least to the greatest.* And they shall not teach every man his neighbor, and every man his brother, saying, 'Know the Lord'; for all shall know Me, from the least to the greatest.

12	<i>For I will be merciful to their unrighteousness, and their sins and their iniquities will I remember no more.</i>	For I will be merciful to their unrighteousness, and their sins and their iniquities will I remember no more."
13	<i>In that he saith, A new covenant, he hath made the first old. Now that which decayeth and waxeth old is ready to vanish away.</i>	In that He says, "A new covenant," He has made the first old. Now that which decays and grows old is ready to vanish away.

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Heb 1:3; Rev 3:21; Col 3:1; Heb 12:2; Heb 7:26-28
- v3 — Eph 5:2; Heb 5:1
- v4 — Heb 7:11-15; Heb 5:1
- v5 — Ex 25:40; Col 2:17; Heb 10:1; Ex 26:30; 1 Chr 28:19
- v6 — Heb 7:22; Gal 3:16-21; Heb 12:24; 2 Pet 1:4; Luke 22:20
- v7 — Heb 7:11; Heb 7:18; Gal 3:21; Heb 8:6
- v8 — Jer 31:31-34; Heb 10:16-17; Heb 12:24; Jer 32:40; Heb 9:15
- v9 — Jer 31:32; Gal 4:24
- v10 — Ezek 36:26-28; Jer 31:33; 2 Cor 3:3; Ezek 11:19-20; Heb 10:16-17
- v11 — Jer 31:34; Isa 54:13; John 6:45; Jer 24:7; 1 John 2:27
- v12 — Heb 10:16-17; Isa 43:25; Rom 11:27; Mic 7:19; Acts 13:38-39
- v13 — 2 Cor 5:17; Heb 7:18-19; Heb 7:11-12; Heb 9:15; Heb 9:9-10

Chapter 9

The author describes the earthly tabernacle and its ordinances of worship, then argues that Christ entered not into a man-made sanctuary but into heaven itself, appearing in the presence of God for us. He declares that without shedding of blood there is no remission, and that Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many, and unto them that look for Him shall He appear the second time without sin unto salvation.

1	<i>Then verily the first covenant had also ordinances of divine service, and a worldly sanctuary.</i>	Then truly the first covenant had also ordinances of divine service, and a worldly sanctuary.
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- 2 *For there was a tabernacle made; the first, wherein was the candlestick, and the table, and the shewbread; which is called the sanctuary.* For there was a tabernacle made; the first, wherein was the candlestick, and the table, and the shewbread; which is called the sanctuary.
- 3 *And after the second veil, the tabernacle which is called the Holiest of all;* And after the second veil, the tabernacle which is called the Holiest of all,
- 4 *Which had the golden censer, and the ark of the covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant;* which had the golden censer, and the ark of the covenant overlaid round about with gold, in which was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant;
- 5 *And over it the cherubims of glory shadowing the mercyseat; of which we cannot now speak particularly.* and over it the cherubims of glory shadowing the mercy seat; of which we cannot now speak particularly.
- 6 *Now when these things were thus ordained, the priests went always into the first tabernacle, accomplishing the service of God.* Now when these things were thus ordained, the priests went always into the first tabernacle, accomplishing the service of God.
- 7 *But into the second went the high priest alone once every year, not without blood, which he offered for himself, and for the errors of the people:* But into the second went the high priest alone once every year, not without blood, which he offered for himself, and for the errors of the people;
- 8 *The Holy Ghost this signifying, that the way into the holiest of all was not yet made manifest, while as the first tabernacle was yet standing:* the Holy Ghost this signifying, that the way into the holiest of all was not yet made manifest, while the first tabernacle was yet standing,
- 9 *Which was a figure for the time then present, in which were offered both gifts and sacrifices, that could not make him that did the service perfect, as pertaining to the conscience;* which was a figure for the time then present, in which were offered both gifts and sacrifices, that could not make Him who did the service perfect, as pertaining to the conscience,

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| <p>10 <i>Which stood only in meats and drinks, and divers washings, and carnal ordinances, imposed on them until the time of reformation.</i></p> <p>11 <i>But Christ being come an high priest of good things to come, by a greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this building;</i></p> | <p>which stood only in meats and drinks, and divers washings, and carnal ordinances, imposed on them until the time of reformation.</p> <p>But Christ being come a high priest of good things to come, by a greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this building;</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (rih-DEMP-shun) — *to buy back; to set free by paying a price. In the ancient world a slave could be redeemed when someone paid the purchase price to set them free. Christ redeemed us from the slavery of sin by paying with His own blood — not with gold or silver, but with His life.*

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| <p>12 <i>Neither by the blood of goats and calves, but by his own blood he entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us.</i></p> <p>13 <i>For if the blood of bulls and of goats, and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean, sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh:</i></p> <p>14 <i>How much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without spot to God, purge your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?</i></p> <p>15 <i>And for this cause he is the mediator of the new testament, that by means of death, for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first testament, they which are called might receive the promise of eternal inheritance.</i></p> | <p>neither by the blood of goats and calves, but by His own blood He entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us.</p> <p>For if the blood of bulls and of goats, and the ashes of a heifer sprinkling the unclean, sanctifies to the purifying of the flesh,</p> <p>how much more shall the blood of Christ, Who through the eternal Spirit offered Himself without spot to God, purge Your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?</p> <p>And for this cause He is the mediator of the new testament, that by means of death, for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first testament, those who are called might receive the promise of eternal inheritance.</p> |
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- 16 *For where a testament is, there must also of necessity be the death of the testator.* For where a testament is, there must also of necessity be the death of the testator.
- 17 *For a testament is of force after men are dead: otherwise it is of no strength at all while the testator liveth.* For a testament is of force after men are dead; otherwise it is of no strength at all while the testator lives.
- 18 *Whereupon neither the first testament was dedicated without blood.* Therefore neither the first testament was dedicated without blood.
- 19 *For when Moses had spoken every precept to all the people according to the law, he took the blood of calves and of goats, with water, and scarlet wool, and hyssop, and sprinkled both the book, and all the people,* For when Moses had spoken every precept to all the people according to the law, he took the blood of calves and of goats, with water, and scarlet wool, and hyssop, and sprinkled both the book, and all the people,
- 20 *Saying, This is the blood of the testament which God hath enjoined unto you.* saying, "This is the blood of the testament which God has enjoined to you."
- 21 *Moreover he sprinkled with blood both the tabernacle, and all the vessels of the ministry.* Moreover he sprinkled with blood both the tabernacle, and all the vessels of the ministry.
- 22 *And almost all things are by the law purged with blood; and without shedding of blood is no remission.* And almost all things are by the law purged with blood; and without shedding of blood is no remission.
- 23 *It was therefore necessary that the patterns of things in the heavens should be purified with these; but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.* It was therefore necessary that the patterns of things in the heavens should be purified with these, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.
- 24 *For Christ is not entered into the holy places made with hands, which are the figures of the true; but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us:* For Christ is not entered into the holy places made with hands, which are the figures of the true; but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us;

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| <p>25 <i>Nor yet that he should offer himself often, as the high priest entereth into the holy place every year with blood of others;</i></p> <p>26 <i>For then must he often have suffered since the foundation of the world: but now once in the end of the world hath he appeared to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And as it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment:</i></p> <p>28 <i>So Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many; and unto them that look for him shall he appear the second time without sin unto salvation.</i></p> | <p>nor yet that He should offer Himself often, as the high priest enters into the holy place every year with blood of others;</p> <p>for then must He often have suffered since the foundation of the world; but now once in the end of the world has He appeared to put away sin by the sacrifice of Himself.</p> <p>And as it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment,</p> <p>so Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many; and to those who look for Him shall He appear the second time without sin to salvation.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

ark of the covenant — The gold-covered wooden chest containing the Ten Commandments — the footstool of God's throne, housed in the tabernacle's Most Holy Place.

mercy seat — The gold lid of the ark of the covenant — the place where the high priest sprinkled blood on the Day of Atonement to make atonement for Israel's sins.

redemption — To buy back, to set free by paying a price — God paid the cost of our sin through Christ's blood to free us.

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

cherubim (*CHAIR-uh-bim*) — Powerful angelic beings — they guarded the Garden of Eden after the Fall and decorated the ark of the covenant; their appearance in Ezekiel has four faces and four wings.

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

shewbread (*SHOW-bred*) — Twelve loaves of unleavened bread placed on the golden table in the Holy Place each Sabbath — representing the twelve tribes before God; also called 'bread of the Presence.'

Cross-References:

v4 — Num 17:10; Ex 26:33; 2 Chr 5:10; Ex 40:3; Lev 16:12

v11 — Heb 9:23-24; 2 Cor 5:1; Heb 8:1-2; Acts 17:24-25; Heb 10:1

- v12 — Heb 10:4; 1 Pet 1:18-19; Heb 9:15; Eph 1:7; Heb 5:9
- v14 — Heb 10:22; 1 Pet 1:19; 1 John 1:7; Heb 9:12; 1 Pet 2:24
- v15 — Rom 3:24-26; Rom 8:30; Heb 9:12; Rom 8:28; Heb 10:36
- v20 — Ex 24:8; Matt 26:28; Heb 13:20
- v22 — Lev 17:11; Lev 6:7; Lev 4:35; Lev 5:18; Lev 14:14
- v23 — 1 Pet 1:19-21; Heb 10:4; Heb 9:14; Heb 9:9-12; Heb 9:24
- v24 — Heb 12:2; Heb 9:11-12; Heb 9:23; Heb 8:2; John 16:28
- v26 — Heb 9:12; 1 Pet 1:20; Heb 1:2; Matt 25:34; 1 Pet 3:18
- v27 — 2 Cor 5:10; Eccl 12:7; Eccl 12:14; Acts 17:31; 2 Sam 14:14
- v28 — Titus 2:13; 1 Pet 2:24; Rom 6:10; Isa 25:9; 2 Tim 4:8

Chapter 10

The author argues that the law's sacrifices, offered year after year, can never make the worshippers perfect, but by one offering Christ has perfected for ever them that are sanctified. He warns that if we sin wilfully after receiving the knowledge of the truth, there remains no more sacrifice for sins but a certain fearful looking for of judgment, and exhorts believers not to forsake the assembling of themselves together.

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| <p>1 <i>For the law having a shadow of good things to come, and not the very image of the things, can never with those sacrifices which they offered year by year continually make the comers thereunto perfect.</i></p> | <p>For the law having a shadow of good things to come, and not the very image of the things, can never with those sacrifices which they offered year by year continually make the comers to them perfect.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>For then would they not have ceased to be offered? because that the worshippers once purged should have had no more conscience of sins.</i></p> | <p>For then would they not have ceased to be offered? Because the worshippers once purged should have had no more conscience of sins.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>But in those sacrifices there is a remembrance again made of sins every year.</i></p> | <p>But in those sacrifices there is a remembrance again made of sins every year.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.</i></p> | <p>For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Wherefore when he cometh into the world, he saith, Sacrifice and offering thou wouldest not, but a body hast thou prepared me:</i></p> | <p>Therefore when He comes into the world, He says, "Sacrifice and offering You would not, but a body have You prepared Me.</p> |

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| 6 <i>In burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin thou hast had no pleasure.</i> | In burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin
You have had no pleasure. |
| 7 <i>Then said I, Lo, I come (in the volume of the book it is written of me,) to do thy will, O God.</i> | Then said I, 'I come (in the volume of the book it is written of Me) to do Your will, O God.' |
| 8 <i>Above when he said, Sacrifice and offering and burnt offerings and offering for sin thou wouldest not, neither hadst pleasure therein; which are offered by the law;</i> | Above when He said, "Sacrifice and offering and burnt offerings and offering for sin You would not, neither had pleasure therein" (which are offered by the law), |
| 9 <i>Then said he, Lo, I come to do thy will, O God. He taketh away the first, that he may establish the second.</i> | then said He, "I come to do Your will, O God." He takes away the first, that He may establish the second. |
| 10 <i>By the which will we are sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.</i> | By that will we are sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all. |
| 11 <i>And every priest standeth daily ministering and offering oftentimes the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins:</i> | And every priest stands daily ministering and offering oftentimes the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins. |
| 12 <i>But this man, after he had offered one sacrifice for sins for ever, sat down on the right hand of God;</i> | But this man, after he had offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down on the right hand of God, |
| 13 <i>From henceforth expecting till his enemies be made his footstool.</i> | from henceforth expecting till His enemies be made His footstool. |
| 14 <i>For by one offering he hath perfected for ever them that are sanctified.</i> | For by one offering He has perfected forever those who are sanctified. |
| 15 <i>Whereof the Holy Ghost also is a witness to us: for after that he had said before,</i> | Of which the Holy Ghost also is a witness to us; for after He had said before, |

- 16 *This is the covenant that I will make with them after those days, saith the Lord, I will put my laws into their hearts, and in their minds will I write them;* "This is the covenant that I will make with them after those days, says the Lord: I will put My laws into their hearts, and in their minds will I write them;
- 17 *And their sins and iniquities will I remember no more.* and their sins and iniquities will I remember no more."
- 18 *Now where remission of these is, there is no more offering for sin.* Now where remission of these is, there is no more offering for sin.
- 19 *Having therefore, brethren, boldness to enter into the holiest by the blood of Jesus,* Having therefore, brethren, boldness to enter into the holiest by the blood of Jesus,
- 20 *By a new and living way, which he hath consecrated for us, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh;* by a new and living way, which He has consecrated for us, through the veil, that is to say, His flesh;
- 21 *And having an high priest over the house of God;* and having a high priest over the house of God,
- 22 *Let us draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience, and our bodies washed with pure water.* let us draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience, and our bodies washed with pure water.
- 23 *Let us hold fast the profession of our faith without wavering; (for he is faithful that promised;)* Let us hold fast the profession of our faith without wavering (for He is faithful who promised),
- 24 *And let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works:* and let us consider one another to provoke to love and to good works,
- 25 *Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another: and so much the more, as ye see the day approaching.* not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another, and so much the more, as You see the day approaching.

- 26 *For if we sin wilfully after that we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remaineth no more sacrifice for sins,* For if we sin wilfully after we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remains no more sacrifice for sins,
- 27 *But a certain fearful looking for of judgment and fiery indignation, which shall devour the adversaries.* but a certain fearful looking for of judgment and fiery indignation, which shall devour the adversaries.
- 28 *He that despised Moses' law died without mercy under two or three witnesses:* He who despised Moses' law died without mercy under two or three witnesses;
- 29 *Of how much sorer punishment, suppose ye, shall he be thought worthy, who hath trodden under foot the Son of God, and hath counted the blood of the covenant, wherewith he was sanctified, an unholy thing, and hath done despite unto the Spirit of grace?* of how much worse punishment, suppose You, shall He be thought worthy, who has trodden under foot the Son of God, and has counted the blood of the covenant, with which He was sanctified, an unholy thing, and has done despite to the Spirit of grace?
- 30 *For we know him that hath said, Vengeance belongeth unto me, I will recompense, saith the Lord. And again, The Lord shall judge his people.* For we know Him who has said, "Vengeance belongs to Me, I will recompense, says the Lord." And again, "The Lord shall judge His people."
- 31 *It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.* It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.
- 32 *But call to remembrance the former days, in which, after ye were illuminated, ye endured a great fight of afflictions;* But call to remembrance the former days, in which, after You were illuminated, You endured a great fight of afflictions:
- 33 *Partly, whilst ye were made a gazingstock both by reproaches and afflictions; and partly, whilst ye became companions of them that were so used.* partly, while You were made a gazingstock both by reproaches and afflictions; and partly, while You became companions of those who were so used.

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| <p>34 <i>For ye had compassion of me in my bonds, and took joyfully the spoiling of your goods, knowing in yourselves that ye have in heaven a better and an enduring substance.</i></p> <p>35 <i>Cast not away therefore your confidence, which hath great recompence of reward.</i></p> <p>36 <i>For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise.</i></p> <p>37 <i>For yet a little while, and he that shall come will come, and will not tarry.</i></p> <p>38 <i>Now the just shall live by faith: but if any man draw back, my soul shall have no pleasure in him.</i></p> <p>39 <i>But we are not of them who draw back unto perdition; but of them that believe to the saving of the soul.</i></p> | <p>For You had compassion on me in my bonds, and took joyfully the spoiling of Your goods, knowing in yourselves that You have in heaven a better and an enduring substance.</p> <p>Cast not away therefore Your confidence, which has great recompense of reward.</p> <p>For You have need of patience, that, after You have done the will of God, You might receive the promise.</p> <p>For yet a little while, and He who shall come will come, and will not tarry.</p> <p>Now the just shall live by faith; but if any man draw back, My soul shall have no pleasure in Him.</p> <p>But we are not of those who draw back to perdition, but of those who believe to the saving of the soul.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

burnt offering — A sacrifice completely consumed by fire on the altar — representing total dedication to God, holding nothing back.

sin offering — A sacrifice made to atone for unintentional sins — covering guilt and restoring the worshipper's standing before God.

Cross-References:

- v5 — Ps 40:6-8; Isa 1:11; Isa 7:14; 1 Pet 2:24; Matt 1:20-23
- v7 — Ps 40:7-8; John 4:34; John 6:38; John 5:30; Heb 10:9-10
- v16 — Jer 31:33-34; Heb 8:8-12; Rom 11:27
- v22 — Ezek 36:25; John 3:5; Eph 5:26; 1 Pet 3:21; 1 Cor 6:11
- v23 — 1 Thess 5:24; 1 Cor 1:9; 2 Thess 3:3; Heb 6:18; Titus 1:2
- v24 — 1 Thess 5:11; 1 John 3:18; Heb 13:1; Gal 5:13; Col 3:16
- v25 — Acts 2:42; 1 Thess 5:11; Matt 18:20; Heb 3:13; Heb 10:24
- v26 — 2 Pet 2:20-22; Heb 6:4-6; John 9:41; Luke 12:47; Matt 12:43-45
- v30 — Deut 32:35-36; Rom 12:19; Nah 1:2; Ps 50:4; 2 Cor 5:10
- v35 — 1 Cor 15:58; Gal 6:8-10; Heb 3:6; Luke 14:14; Heb 11:26

v36 — Heb 12:1; Ps 37:7; Jas 5:7-11; 1 Cor 13:7; Luke 21:19

v38 — Gal 3:11; Hab 2:4; Rom 1:17; Ps 85:8; Heb 6:4-6

Chapter 11

The author defines faith as the substance of things hoped for and the evidence of things not seen, then recounts the great cloud of witnesses who lived by faith. By faith Abel offered, by faith Noah built the ark, by faith Abraham obeyed, by faith Moses chose to suffer with the people of God, and all these obtained a good report through faith though they did not receive the promise.

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| 1 | <i>Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.</i> | Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen. |
| 2 | <i>For by it the elders obtained a good report.</i> | For by it the elders obtained a good report. |
| 3 | <i>Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear.</i> | Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear. |
| 4 | <i>By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh.</i> | By faith Abel offered to God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of His gifts; and by it He being dead yet speaks. |
| 5 | <i>By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death; and was not found, because God had translated him: for before his translation he had this testimony, that he pleased God.</i> | By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death, and was not found, because God had translated him; for before His translation He had this testimony, that He pleased God. |
| 6 | <i>But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.</i> | But without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him. |

- 7 *By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of his house; by the which he condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.* By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of His house; by which He condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.
- 8 *By faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should after receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing whither he went.* By faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should afterward receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing where he went.
- 9 *By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise:* By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise;
- 10 *For he looked for a city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker is God.* for he looked for a city which has foundations, whose builder and maker is God.
- 11 *Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed, and was delivered of a child when she was past age, because she judged him faithful who had promised.* Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed, and was delivered of a child when she was past age, because she judged Him faithful who had promised.
- 12 *Therefore sprang there even of one, and him as good as dead, so many as the stars of the sky in multitude, and as the sand which is by the sea shore innumerable.* Therefore sprang there even of one, and him as good as dead, so many as the stars of the sky in multitude, and as the sand which is by the seashore innumerable.
- 13 *These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, and embraced them, and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth.* These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, and embraced them, and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth.

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| <p>14 <i>For they that say such things declare plainly that they seek a country.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And truly, if they had been mindful of that country from whence they came out, they might have had opportunity to have returned.</i></p> <p>16 <i>But now they desire a better country, that is, an heavenly: wherefore God is not ashamed to be called their God: for he hath prepared for them a city.</i></p> | <p>For those who say such things declare plainly that they seek a country.</p> <p>And truly, if they had been mindful of that country from where they came out, they might have had opportunity to have returned.</p> <p>But now they desire a better country, that is, a heavenly one; therefore God is not ashamed to be called their God, for He has prepared for them a city.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Only begotten** (OH-nlee bih-GOT-ten) — *the unique, one-of-a-kind Son; Christ is God's Son in a way that no one else can be. The Greek word "monogenes" points to absolute uniqueness — not just firstborn or highly favored, but the only one of His kind. Isaac was Abraham's only begotten in the sense of the promise; Christ is the only begotten Son of God in an eternal and unrepeatable sense.*

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| <p>17 <i>By faith Abraham, when he was tried, offered up Isaac: and he that had received the promises offered up his only begotten son,</i></p> <p>18 <i>Of whom it was said, That in Isaac shall thy seed be called:</i></p> <p>19 <i>Accounting that God was able to raise him up, even from the dead; from whence also he received him in a figure.</i></p> <p>20 <i>By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau concerning things to come.</i></p> <p>21 <i>By faith Jacob, when he was a dying, blessed both the sons of Joseph; and worshipped, leaning upon the top of his staff.</i></p> | <p>By faith Abraham, when he was tried, offered up Isaac; and he who had received the promises offered up his only begotten son,</p> <p>of whom it was said, "In Isaac shall your seed be called,"</p> <p>accounting that God was able to raise Him up, even from the dead, from where also He received Him in a figure.</p> <p>By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau concerning things to come.</p> <p>By faith Jacob, when he was dying, blessed both the sons of Joseph, and worshipped, leaning on the top of his staff.</p> |
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- 22 *By faith Joseph, when he died, made mention of the departing of the children of Israel; and gave commandment concerning his bones.* By faith Joseph, when he died, made mention of the departing of the children of Israel, and gave commandment concerning his bones.
- 23 *By faith Moses, when he was born, was hid three months of his parents, because they saw he was a proper child; and they were not afraid of the king's commandment.* By faith Moses, when he was born, was hid three months of his parents, because they saw he was a proper child, and they were not afraid of the king's commandment.
- 24 *By faith Moses, when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter;* By faith Moses, when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter,
- 25 *Choosing rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season;* choosing rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season,
- 26 *Esteeming the reproach of Christ greater riches than the treasures in Egypt: for he had respect unto the recompence of the reward.* esteeming the reproach of Christ greater riches than the treasures in Egypt, for He had respect to the recompense of the reward.
- 27 *By faith he forsook Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king: for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible.* By faith he forsook Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king, for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible.
- 28 *Through faith he kept the passover, and the sprinkling of blood, lest he that destroyed the firstborn should touch them.* Through faith he kept the passover, and the sprinkling of blood, lest he who destroyed the firstborn should touch them.
- 29 *By faith they passed through the Red sea as by dry land: which the Egyptians assaying to do were drowned.* By faith they passed through the Red sea as by dry land, which the Egyptians attempting to do were drowned.
- 30 *By faith the walls of Jericho fell down, after they were compassed about seven days.* By faith the walls of Jericho fell down, after they were compassed about seven days.

- 31 *By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with them that believed not, when she had received the spies with peace.* By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with those who believed not, when she had received the spies with peace.
- 32 *And what shall I more say? for the time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets:* And what shall I more say? For the time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets;
- 33 *Who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions,* who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions,
- 34 *Quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens.* quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens.
- 35 *Women received their dead raised to life again: and others were tortured, not accepting deliverance; that they might obtain a better resurrection:* Women received their dead raised to life again; and others were tortured, not accepting deliverance, that they might obtain a better resurrection;
- 36 *And others had trial of cruel mockings and scourgings, yea, moreover of bonds and imprisonment:* and others had trial of cruel mockings and scourgings, yes, moreover of bonds and imprisonment.
- 37 *They were stoned, they were sawn asunder, were tempted, were slain with the sword: they wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins; being destitute, afflicted, tormented;* They were stoned, they were sawn asunder, were tempted, were slain with the sword; they wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins, being destitute, afflicted, tormented
- 38 *(Of whom the world was not worthy:) they wandered in deserts, and in mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth.* (of whom the world was not worthy); they wandered in deserts, and in mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth.

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| 39 | <i>And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise:</i> | And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise, |
| 40 | <i>God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect.</i> | God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect. |
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Words in this chapter:

only begotten — The unique, one-of-a-kind Son — Christ is God's Son in a way no one else can be; 'begotten' is not about birth but eternal relationship.

passover — The annual feast commemorating Israel's deliverance from Egypt — the LORD 'passed over' the houses marked with blood and spared the firstborn.

Abel (*AY-bel*) — Adam and Eve's second son — a shepherd whose offering God accepted; murdered by his brother Cain; in the NT, a model of faith.

Cain (*KAYN*) — Adam and Eve's firstborn son — he killed his brother Abel and was sent away under God's curse to wander the earth.

Enoch (*EE-nok*) — A man who 'walked with God' — he did not die but was taken by God; ancestor of Noah; father of Methuselah.

Esau (*EE-saw*) — Isaac's firstborn son — hairy and a skilled hunter; sold his birthright to Jacob for lentil stew; ancestor of the Edomites.

Gideon (*GID-ee-on*) — A judge who defeated the Midianites with 300 men — God reduced his army to show the victory was His alone; his name means 'mighty warrior.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Cor 5:7; 2 Cor 4:18; Rom 8:24-25; Heb 11:7; Heb 10:22
- v3 — Ps 33:6; John 1:3; 2 Pet 3:5; Rom 4:17; Acts 17:24
- v4 — Gen 4:3-5; 1 John 3:11-12; Heb 12:24; Prov 15:8; Matt 23:35
- v5 — Gen 5:21-24; Jude 1:14; Heb 11:6; 2 Kgs 2:11; Rev 11:9-12
- v6 — Prov 8:17; Jer 29:13-14; Matt 6:33; 1 Chr 28:9; Ps 105:3-4
- v7 — Gen 6:13-7:1; 1 Pet 3:20; Ezek 14:14; Luke 17:26; Rom 4:13
- v8 — Gen 12:1-4; Acts 7:2-4; Matt 7:24-25; Gen 15:7-8; Gen 22:18
- v10 — Heb 13:14; Phil 3:20; 2 Cor 5:1; Heb 12:22; John 14:2
- v11 — Rom 4:20-21; Heb 10:23; Gen 18:11-14; Gen 21:1-2; Luke 1:36
- v12 — Gen 22:17; Gen 32:12; Hos 1:10; Gen 15:5; Jer 33:22
- v13 — Ps 39:12; Gen 23:4; Heb 11:27; John 8:56; 1 Chr 29:14-15
- v16 — Heb 13:14; Phil 3:20; Heb 11:10; Matt 25:34; John 14:2

Chapter 12

The author urges believers to run with patience the race set before them, looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of their faith, who endured the cross for the joy that was set before Him. He teaches that God chastens those He loves as a father disciplines his children, and warns that if the Israelites did not escape who refused him that spoke on earth, much less shall we escape if we turn away from Him who speaks from heaven.

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| 1 <i>Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us,</i> | Therefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which does so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, |
| 2 <i>Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.</i> | looking to Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God. |
| 3 <i>For consider him that endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, lest ye be wearied and faint in your minds.</i> | For consider Him who endured such contradiction of sinners against Himself, lest You be wearied and faint in Your minds. |
| 4 <i>Ye have not yet resisted unto blood, striving against sin.</i> | You have not yet resisted to blood, striving against sin. |
| 5 <i>And ye have forgotten the exhortation which speaketh unto you as unto children, My son, despise not thou the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when thou art rebuked of him:</i> | And You have forgotten the exhortation which speaks to You as to children, "My son, despise not the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when You are rebuked of Him; |
| 6 <i>For whom the Lord loveth he chasteneth, and scourgeth every son whom he receiveth.</i> | for whom the Lord loves He chastens, and scourges every son whom He receives." |
| 7 <i>If ye endure chastening, God dealeth with you as with sons; for what son is he whom the father chasteneth not?</i> | If You endure chastening, God deals with You as with sons; for what son is He whom the father chastens not? |

- 8 *But if ye be without chastisement, whereof all are partakers, then are ye bastards, and not sons.* But if You be without chastisement, of which all are partakers, then are You bastards, and not sons.
- 9 *Furthermore we have had fathers of our flesh which corrected us, and we gave them reverence: how much more shall we be in subjection unto the Father of spirits, and live?* Furthermore we have had fathers of our flesh who corrected us, and we gave them reverence; how much more shall we be in subjection to the Father of spirits, and live?
- 10 *For they verily for a few days chastened us after their own pleasure; but he for our profit, that we might be partakers of his holiness.* For they truly for a few days chastened us after their own pleasure; but He for our profit, that we might be partakers of His holiness.
- 11 *Now no chastening for the present seemeth to be joyous, but grievous: nevertheless afterward it yieldeth the peaceable fruit of righteousness unto them which are exercised thereby.* Now no chastening for the present seems to be joyous, but grievous; nevertheless afterward it yields the peaceable fruit of righteousness to those who are exercised thereby.
- 12 *Wherefore lift up the hands which hang down, and the feeble knees;* Therefore lift up the hands which hang down, and the feeble knees,
- 13 *And make straight paths for your feet, lest that which is lame be turned out of the way; but let it rather be healed.* and make straight paths for Your feet, lest that which is lame be turned out of the way; but let it rather be healed.
- 14 *Follow peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord:* Follow peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord,
- 15 *Looking diligently lest any man fail of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you, and thereby many be defiled;* looking diligently lest any man fail of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble You, and thereby many be defiled;
- 16 *Lest there be any fornicator, or profane person, as Esau, who for one morsel of meat sold his birthright.* lest there be any fornicator, or profane person, as Esau, who for one morsel of meat sold his birthright.

- 17 *For ye know how that afterward, when he would have inherited the blessing, he was rejected: for he found no place of repentance, though he sought it carefully with tears.* For you know how that afterward, when he would have inherited the blessing, he was rejected; for he found no place of repentance, though he sought it carefully with tears.
- 18 *For ye are not come unto the mount that might be touched, and that burned with fire, nor unto blackness, and darkness, and tempest,* For you are not come to the mount that might be touched, and that burned with fire, nor to blackness, and darkness, and tempest,
- 19 *And the sound of a trumpet, and the voice of words; which voice they that heard intreated that the word should not be spoken to them any more:* and the sound of a trumpet, and the voice of words; which voice those who heard entreated that the word should not be spoken to them any more
- 20 *(For they could not endure that which was commanded, And if so much as a beast touch the mountain, it shall be stoned, or thrust through with a dart:* (for they could not endure that which was commanded, "And if so much as a beast touch the mountain, it shall be stoned, or thrust through with a dart";
- 21 *And so terrible was the sight, that Moses said, I exceedingly fear and quake:)* and so terrible was the sight, that Moses said, "I exceedingly fear and quake");
- 22 *But ye are come unto mount Sion, and unto the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels,* but you are come to mount Sion, and to the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels,
- 23 *To the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect,* to the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect,
- 24 *And to Jesus the mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling, that speaketh better things than that of Abel.* and to Jesus the mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling, that speaks better things than that of Abel.

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| <p>25 <i>See that ye refuse not him that speaketh. For if they escaped not who refused him that spake on earth, much more shall not we escape, if we turn away from him that speaketh from heaven:</i></p> <p>26 <i>Whose voice then shook the earth: but now he hath promised, saying, Yet once more I shake not the earth only, but also heaven.</i></p> <p>27 <i>And this word, Yet once more, signifieth the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that are made, that those things which cannot be shaken may remain.</i></p> <p>28 <i>Wherefore we receiving a kingdom which cannot be moved, let us have grace, whereby we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear:</i></p> <p>29 <i>For our God is a consuming fire.</i></p> | <p>See that You refuse not Him who speaks. For if they escaped not who refused Him who spoke on earth, much more shall we not escape, if we turn away from Him who speaks from heaven;</p> <p>whose voice then shook the earth; but now He has promised, saying, "Yet once more I shake not the earth only, but also heaven."</p> <p>And this word, "Yet once more," signifies the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that are made, that those things which cannot be shaken may remain.</p> <p>Therefore we receiving a kingdom which cannot be moved, let us have grace, by which we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear;</p> <p>for our God is a consuming fire.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 2 Tim 4:7; 1 Cor 9:24-27; Phil 2:16; Luke 21:34; Heb 10:35-39
- v2 — Mic 7:7; 1 Pet 3:18; 1 Pet 2:23-24; Heb 1:3; Phil 1:6
- v3 — Gal 6:9; 2 Cor 4:16; Rev 2:3; 1 Cor 15:58; Heb 12:2
- v5 — Prov 3:11-12; Job 5:17-18; Rev 3:19; 1 Cor 11:32; Ps 94:12
- v6 — Rev 3:19; Prov 3:12; Ps 119:75; Prov 13:24; Ps 94:12
- v9 — Num 16:22; Num 27:16; Isa 42:5; John 3:6; Job 12:10
- v11 — Rom 5:3-5; 2 Cor 4:17; Heb 12:5-6; 1 Pet 1:6; Heb 12:10
- v14 — 2 Cor 7:1; 1 Pet 1:15-16; 1 Thess 4:7; Matt 5:8-9; Rom 12:18
- v24 — Heb 9:15; Heb 11:28; Heb 8:6; Heb 11:4; 1 Tim 2:5
- v26 — Hag 2:6-7; Isa 13:13; Ex 19:18; Isa 2:19; Joel 3:16

v28 — Rom 12:1-2; Ps 2:11; Heb 13:15; Dan 2:44; Heb 4:16

v29 — Deut 4:24; Deut 9:3; 2 Thess 1:8; Isa 66:15; Heb 10:27

Chapter 13

The author gives practical exhortations: let brotherly love continue, be hospitable to strangers, honor marriage, be content with what you have, and remember those who have taught you the word of God. He declares that Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever, and prays that the God of peace would make them perfect in every good work to do His will.

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| 1 | <i>Let brotherly love continue.</i> | Let brotherly love continue. |
| 2 | <i>Be not forgetful to entertain strangers: for thereby some have entertained angels unawares.</i> | Be not forgetful to entertain strangers, for thereby some have entertained angels unawares. |
| 3 | <i>Remember them that are in bonds, as bound with them; and them which suffer adversity, as being yourselves also in the body.</i> | Remember those who are in bonds, as bound with them; and those who suffer adversity, as being yourselves also in the body. |
| 4 | <i>Marriage is honourable in all, and the bed undefiled: but whoremongers and adulterers God will judge.</i> | Marriage is honorable in all, and the bed undefiled; but whoremongers and adulterers God will judge. |
| 5 | <i>Let your conversation be without covetousness; and be content with such things as ye have: for he hath said, I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee.</i> | Let Your conversation be without covetousness; and be content with such things as You have; for He has said, "I will never leave You, nor forsake You." |
| 6 | <i>So that we may boldly say, The Lord is my helper, and I will not fear what man shall do unto me.</i> | So that we may boldly say, "The Lord is my helper, and I will not fear what man shall do to me." |
| 7 | <i>Remember them which have the rule over you, who have spoken unto you the word of God: whose faith follow, considering the end of their conversation.</i> | Remember those who have the rule over You, who have spoken to You the word of God; whose faith follow, considering the end of their conversation. |
| 8 | <i>Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever.</i> | Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and today, and forever. |

- 9 *Be not carried about with divers and strange doctrines. For it is a good thing that the heart be established with grace; not with meats, which have not profited them that have been occupied therein.* Be not carried about with divers and strange doctrines. For it is a good thing that the heart be established with grace; not with meats, which have not profited those who have been occupied with them.
- 10 *We have an altar, whereof they have no right to eat which serve the tabernacle.* We have an altar, of which they have no right to eat who serve the tabernacle.
- 11 *For the bodies of those beasts, whose blood is brought into the sanctuary by the high priest for sin, are burned without the camp.* For the bodies of those beasts, whose blood is brought into the sanctuary by the high priest for sin, are burned outside the camp.
- 12 *Wherefore Jesus also, that he might sanctify the people with his own blood, suffered without the gate.* Therefore Jesus also, that He might sanctify the people with his own blood, suffered outside the gate.
- 13 *Let us go forth therefore unto him without the camp, bearing his reproach.* Let us go forth therefore to Him outside the camp, bearing His reproach.
- 14 *For here have we no continuing city, but we seek one to come.* For here we have no continuing city, but we seek one to come.
- 15 *By him therefore let us offer the sacrifice of praise to God continually, that is, the fruit of our lips giving thanks to his name.* By Him therefore let us offer the sacrifice of praise to God continually, that is, the fruit of our lips giving thanks to His name.
- 16 *But to do good and to communicate forget not: for with such sacrifices God is well pleased.* But to do good and to communicate forget not, for with such sacrifices God is well pleased.
- 17 *Obey them that have the rule over you, and submit yourselves: for they watch for your souls, as they that must give account, that they may do it with joy, and not with grief: for that is unprofitable for you.* Obey those who have the rule over You, and submit yourselves; for they watch for Your souls, as those who must give account, that they may do it with joy, and not with grief; for that is unprofitable for You.

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| <p>18 <i>Pray for us: for we trust we have a good conscience, in all things willing to live honestly.</i></p> <p>19 <i>But I beseech you the rather to do this, that I may be restored to you the sooner.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Now the God of peace, that brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus, that great shepherd of the sheep, through the blood of the everlasting covenant,</i></p> <p>21 <i>Make you perfect in every good work to do his will, working in you that which is wellpleasing in his sight, through Jesus Christ; to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.</i></p> <p>22 <i>And I beseech you, brethren, suffer the word of exhortation: for I have written a letter unto you in few words.</i></p> <p>23 <i>Know ye that our brother Timothy is set at liberty; with whom, if he come shortly, I will see you.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Salute all them that have the rule over you, and all the saints. They of Italy salute you.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Grace be with you all. Amen.</i></p> | <p>Pray for us; for we trust we have a good conscience, in all things willing to live honestly.</p> <p>But I beseech You the rather to do this, that I may be restored to You the sooner.</p> <p>Now the God of peace, who brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus, that great shepherd of the sheep, through the blood of the everlasting covenant,</p> <p>make You perfect in every good work to do His will, working in You that which is well pleasing in His sight, through Jesus Christ; to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen.</p> <p>And I beseech You, brethren, bear with the word of exhortation, for I have written a letter to You in few words.</p> <p>Know that our brother Timothy is set at liberty; with whom, if he come shortly, I will see you.</p> <p>Salute all those who have the rule over you, and all the saints. Those of Italy salute you.</p> <p>Grace be with you all. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Cross-References:

v2 — Matt 25:35; Gen 18:1-19:3; 1 Pet 4:9; Rom 12:13; Matt 25:43

v4 — Gen 2:24; Prov 5:15-23; 1 Cor 7:2-16; Gal 5:19; Gen 1:27-28

v5 — Deut 31:8; Josh 1:5; Deut 31:6; 1 Sam 12:22; Isa 41:17

- v6** — Ps 118:6-9; Isa 41:10; Rom 8:31; Ps 27:1-3; Ps 124:8
v7 — 1 Thess 5:12-13; Heb 13:17; Phil 3:17; Heb 6:12; 1 Thess 1:6
v8 — Mal 3:6; Jas 1:17; Rev 1:8; Heb 1:12; Isa 44:6
v9 — Eph 4:14; 1 Tim 6:3-5; Eph 5:6; 1 John 4:1; Rom 14:6
v15 — Ps 107:21-22; Ps 50:14; Rom 12:1; Ps 145:1-21; 1 Pet 2:5
v16 — 2 Thess 3:13; Gal 6:10; Rom 12:13; Heb 6:10; Heb 13:1-2
v17 — 1 Thess 5:12-13; 1 Tim 5:17; Heb 13:7; 1 Pet 5:5; Acts 20:28
v20 — John 10:11; Heb 10:22; Ps 23:1; Rom 15:33; John 10:14
v21 — Phil 2:13; 2 Thess 2:17; Phil 4:13; 1 Pet 5:10-11; 1 Pet 2:5

James

Author: James, the brother of the Lord — the leader of the Jerusalem church and one of the "pillars" Paul mentions in Galatians 2:9; martyred c. AD 62 according to Josephus.

Date written: c. AD 45–50, possibly the earliest of all NT letters, written before the Jerusalem Council of Acts 15.

Written to: Jewish Christians scattered throughout the Roman world — "the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad" (1:1).

Setting: The early church is young and dispersed by persecution. Jewish believers are carrying their faith into a pagan world. The practical challenges of living as Christians amid poverty, partiality, conflict, and temptation are immediate and pressing.

Where this sits historically: Written from Jerusalem under Claudius before the Jerusalem Council of Acts 15 — likely the earliest NT book, less than twenty years after the resurrection.

Contemporaries: Peter and John still ministered in Jerusalem, Paul and Barnabas were on their first missionary journey, and Galatians may have been composed in roughly the same window.

Big themes:

- Faith and works — James's most famous teaching: "faith without works is dead" (2:26); saving faith necessarily produces visible obedience — he does not contradict Paul but completes him, addressing a different error
- Trials and patience — the letter opens with the paradox that trials are occasions for joy, because they produce patience and maturity
- The tongue — chapter 3 contains the NT's most extended teaching on speech; the tongue is a small member but capable of setting a great fire
- Partiality — showing favoritism to the rich over the poor in the assembly is a violation of the royal law of love (ch. 2)
- Prayer — the prayer of a righteous man "availeth much" (5:16); Elijah is the example of what faith-filled prayer can accomplish

Key passages: Jas 1:2–4; 1:22; 2:17; 4:7–8; 5:16

How it fits: James is the NT's book of practical wisdom — the Proverbs of the NT in many ways. It was written to dispersed Jewish Christians who needed not more theology but more obedience. Luther's uneasiness with it ("epistle of straw") reflects a misreading; James and Paul attack different errors and are perfectly compatible. James serves as the NT's answer to mere theoretical faith.

Chapter 1

James instructs believers to count it all joy when they face various trials, for the trying of faith works patience. He teaches that every good and perfect gift comes from the Father of lights, that a man is tempted when he is drawn away by his own lust, and that believers must be doers of the word and not hearers only.

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| 1 <i>James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad, greeting.</i> | James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad, greeting. |
| 2 <i>My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations;</i> | My brethren, count it all joy when You fall into divers temptations, |
| 3 <i>Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.</i> | knowing this, that the trying of Your faith works patience. |
| 4 <i>But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing.</i> | But let patience have her perfect work, that You may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing. |
| 5 <i>If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him.</i> | If any of You lack wisdom, let Him ask of God, Who gives to all men liberally, and upbraids not; and it shall be given Him. |
| 6 <i>But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.</i> | But let Him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For He who wavers is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed. |
| 7 <i>For let not that man think that he shall receive any thing of the Lord.</i> | For let not that man think that he shall receive anything from the Lord. |
| 8 <i>A double minded man is unstable in all his ways.</i> | A doubleminded man is unstable in all His ways. |
| 9 <i>Let the brother of low degree rejoice in that he is exalted:</i> | Let the brother of low degree rejoice in that He is exalted, |
| 10 <i>But the rich, in that he is made low: because as the flower of the grass he shall pass away.</i> | but the rich, in that He is made low; because as the flower of the grass He shall pass away. |

- 11 *For the sun is no sooner risen with a burning heat, but it withereth the grass, and the flower thereof falleth, and the grace of the fashion of it perisheth: so also shall the rich man fade away in his ways.* For the sun is no sooner risen with a burning heat, but it withers the grass, and the flower thereof falls, and the grace of the fashion of it perishes; so also shall the rich man fade away in his ways.
- 12 *Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him.* Blessed is the man who endures temptation, for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord has promised to those who love Him.
- 13 *Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man:* Let no man say when he is tempted, "I am tempted of God"; for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither does He tempt any man;
- 14 *But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.* but every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.
- 15 *Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death.* Then when lust has conceived, it brings forth sin; and sin, when it is finished, brings forth death.
- 16 *Do not err, my beloved brethren.* Do not err, my beloved brethren.
- 17 *Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.* Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and comes down from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.
- 18 *Of his own will begat he us with the word of truth, that we should be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures.* Of His own will He begat us with the word of truth, that we should be a kind of firstfruits of His creatures.
- 19 *Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath:* Therefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath;

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| 20 | <i>For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.</i> | for the wrath of man works not the righteousness of God. |
| 21 | <i>Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.</i> | Therefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save Your souls. |
| 22 | <i>But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.</i> | But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving Your own selves. |
| 23 | <i>For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass:</i> | For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, He is like a man beholding his natural face in a glass; |
| 24 | <i>For he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was.</i> | for He beholds Himself, and goes His way, and straightway forgets what manner of man He was. |
| 25 | <i>But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed.</i> | But whoever looks into the perfect law of liberty, and continues therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed. |
| 26 | <i>If any man among you seem to be religious, and bridleth not his tongue, but deceiveth his own heart, this man's religion is vain.</i> | If any man among you seem to be religious, and bridles not his tongue, but deceives his own heart, this man's religion is vain. |
| 27 | <i>Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.</i> | Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this: to visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep Himself unspotted from the world. |

Words in this chapter:

divers — Various; diverse; several different — 'divers diseases' means various kinds of illness; not related to diving.

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 1 Pet 1:6-8; Jas 1:12; 2 Cor 12:9-10; Matt 5:10-12; Luke 6:22-23
 v3 — Rom 5:3-4; Heb 10:36; Col 1:11; Rom 8:28; 2 Cor 4:17
 v5 — Prov 2:3-6; John 15:7; Jer 29:12-13; Prov 3:5-7; 1 John 5:14-15
 v6 — Matt 21:21-22; Heb 11:6; Mark 11:22-24; Eph 4:14; Heb 10:23
 v8 — 1 Kgs 18:21; Matt 6:24; Jas 4:8; Isa 29:13; 2 Pet 2:14
 v12 — 1 Pet 5:10; 1 Pet 1:6-8; Rev 2:10; Jas 5:11; Rom 8:28
 v17 — John 3:27; Matt 7:11; Heb 13:8; John 8:12; Num 23:19
 v19 — Prov 17:27; Prov 21:23; Prov 14:29; Prov 10:19; Prov 18:13
 v21 — Eph 4:22; Eph 1:13; 1 Pet 2:11; John 6:63; Ps 25:9
 v22 — Rom 2:13; Luke 6:46-48; John 13:17; Jas 4:17; 1 John 2:3
 v26 — Eph 4:29; Ps 141:3; 1 Pet 3:10; Eph 5:4; Ps 34:13
 v27 — Isa 1:16-17; 1 John 3:17-19; Gal 6:9-10; Rom 12:2; Matt 25:34-46

Chapter 2

James rebukes favoritism toward the rich in the assembly and teaches that if a man shows respect of persons he commits sin. He argues that faith without works is dead, citing Abraham who was justified by works when he offered Isaac, and Rahab who was justified by works when she received the messengers — for as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also.

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| <p>1 <i>My brethren, have not the faith of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Lord of glory, with respect of persons.</i></p> | My brethren, do not hold the faith of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Lord of glory, with respect of persons. |
| <p>2 <i>For if there come unto your assembly a man with a gold ring, in goodly apparel, and there come in also a poor man in vile raiment;</i></p> | For if there come to Your assembly a man with a gold ring, in goodly apparel, and there comes in also a poor man in vile raiment, |
| <p>3 <i>And ye have respect to him that weareth the gay clothing, and say unto him, Sit thou here in a good place; and say to the poor, Stand thou there, or sit here under my footstool:</i></p> | and You have respect to Him who wears the gay clothing, and say to Him, "Sit here in a good place"; and say to the poor, "Stand there," or, "Sit here under my footstool," |
| <p>4 <i>Are ye not then partial in yourselves, and are become judges of evil thoughts?</i></p> | are You not then partial in yourselves, and become judges of evil thoughts? |

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| <p>5 <i>Hearken, my beloved brethren, Hath not God chosen the poor of this world rich in faith, and heirs of the kingdom which he hath promised to them that love him?</i></p> <p>6 <i>But ye have despised the poor. Do not rich men oppress you, and draw you before the judgment seats?</i></p> <p>7 <i>Do not they blaspheme that worthy name by the which ye are called?</i></p> <p>8 <i>If ye fulfil the royal law according to the scripture, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself, ye do well:</i></p> <p>9 <i>But if ye have respect to persons, ye commit sin, and are convinced of the law as transgressors.</i></p> <p>10 <i>For whosoever shall keep the whole law, and yet offend in one point, he is guilty of all.</i></p> <p>11 <i>For he that said, Do not commit adultery, said also, Do not kill. Now if thou commit no adultery, yet if thou kill, thou art become a transgressor of the law.</i></p> <p>12 <i>So speak ye, and so do, as they that shall be judged by the law of liberty.</i></p> | <p>Listen, my beloved brethren, has not God chosen the poor of this world rich in faith, and heirs of the kingdom which He has promised to those who love Him?</p> <p>But You have despised the poor. Do not rich men oppress You, and draw You before the judgment seats?</p> <p>Do they not blaspheme that worthy name by which You are called?</p> <p>If You fulfill the royal law according to the scripture, "You shall love Your neighbor as Yourself," you do well;</p> <p>but if You have respect to persons, You commit sin, and are convicted of the law as transgressors.</p> <p>For whoever shall keep the whole law, and yet offend in one point, He is guilty of all.</p> <p>For He who said, "Do not commit adultery," said also, "Do not kill." Now if You commit no adultery, yet if You kill, You have become a transgressor of the law.</p> <p>So speak, and so do, as those who shall be judged by the law of liberty.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — *Mercy* (MUR-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. Mercy is not ignoring sin — it is the sovereign choice of God to spare the guilty. James shows here that those who have received God's mercy must pass mercy on to others.

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| <p>13 <i>For he shall have judgment without mercy, that hath shewed no mercy; and mercy rejoiceth against judgment.</i></p> | <p>For He shall have judgment without mercy who has shown no mercy; and mercy rejoices against judgment.</p> |
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| 14 <i>What doth it profit, my brethren,
though a man say he hath faith, and
have not works? can faith save him?</i> | What does it profit, my brethren,
though a man say he has faith, and
have not works? Can faith save Him? |
| 15 <i>If a brother or sister be naked, and
destitute of daily food,</i> | If a brother or sister be naked, and
destitute of daily food, |
| 16 <i>And one of you say unto them, Depart
in peace, be ye warmed and filled;
notwithstanding ye give them not
those things which are needful to the
body; what doth it profit?</i> | and one of You say to them, "Depart in
peace, be warmed and filled,"
notwithstanding You give them not
those things which are needful to the
body, what does it profit? |
| 17 <i>Even so faith, if it hath not works, is
dead, being alone.</i> | Even so faith, if it has not works, is
dead, being alone. |
| 18 <i>Yea, a man may say, Thou hast faith,
and I have works: shew me thy faith
without thy works, and I will shew
thee my faith by my works.</i> | Yes, a man may say, "You have faith,
and I have works." Show me Your
faith without Your works, and I will
show You my faith by my works. |
| 19 <i>Thou believest that there is one God;
thou doest well: the devils also
believe, and tremble.</i> | You believe that there is one God; You
do well. The devils also believe, and
tremble. |
| 20 <i>But wilt thou know, O vain man, that
faith without works is dead?</i> | But will You know, O vain man, that
faith without works is dead? |
| 21 <i>Was not Abraham our father justified
by works, when he had offered Isaac
his son upon the altar?</i> | Was not Abraham our father justified
by works, when he had offered Isaac
his son on the altar? |
| 22 <i>Seest thou how faith wrought with his
works, and by works was faith made
perfect?</i> | Do you see how faith wrought with his
works, and by works was faith made
perfect? |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Imputed** (im-PYOO-ted) — *credited to your account; charged against or counted for someone. When God imputes righteousness to a believer, He counts Christ's perfect record as belonging to that person. Our sin was imputed to Christ on the cross; His righteousness is imputed to us by faith.*

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| <p>23 <i>And the scripture was fulfilled which saith, Abraham believed God, and it was imputed unto him for righteousness: and he was called the Friend of God.</i></p> <p>24 <i>Ye see then how that by works a man is justified, and not by faith only.</i></p> <p>25 <i>Likewise also was not Rahab the harlot justified by works, when she had received the messengers, and had sent them out another way?</i></p> <p>26 <i>For as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also.</i></p> | <p>And the scripture was fulfilled which says, "Abraham believed God, and it was imputed to Him for righteousness," and He was called the Friend of God.</p> <p>You see then how that by works a man is justified, and not by faith only.</p> <p>Likewise also was not Rahab the harlot justified by works, when she had received the messengers, and had sent them out another way?</p> <p>For as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

imputed — Credited to your account — our sin charged to Christ, His righteousness counted as ours.

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Isaac (*EYE-zak*) — The son God promised to Abraham and Sarah — his name means 'he laughs'; offered as a sacrifice on Mount Moriah, but God provided a ram instead.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Prov 24:23; Jas 2:9; Deut 16:19; Lev 19:15; Deut 1:17
- v5 — Matt 5:3; Luke 6:20; Rev 2:9; 1 Cor 1:26-28; 2 Cor 8:9
- v8 — Lev 19:18; Gal 5:14; Matt 22:39; Jas 2:12; Rom 13:8-9
- v10 — Gal 3:10; Matt 5:18-19; Deut 27:26
- v13 — Matt 5:7; Matt 6:15; Prov 21:13; Luke 6:37; Eph 2:4-7
- v14 — Matt 7:26-27; Matt 7:21-23; Jas 1:22-25; Luke 6:49; Titus 1:16
- v17 — Jas 2:26; 2 Pet 1:5-9; Jas 2:19-20; Jas 2:14; 1 Cor 13:13
- v18 — Jas 3:13; Jas 2:14; 1 Tim 1:5; Gal 5:6; Titus 2:7
- v19 — Luke 4:34; Mark 1:24; Matt 8:29; Acts 16:17; Deut 6:4
- v23 — Gen 15:6; Isa 41:8; 2 Chr 20:7; Gal 3:6; Rom 4:22-24
- v25 — Heb 11:31; Josh 6:22-25; Josh 2:19-21; Josh 2:4; Josh 2:15
- v26 — Jas 2:20; Jas 2:17; Jas 2:14; Eccl 12:7

Chapter 3

James warns about the power of the tongue, declaring that it is a little member that boasts great things, a fire, a world of iniquity that no man can tame. He contrasts the wisdom from above — which is pure, peaceable, gentle, and full of mercy — with the wisdom that is earthly, sensual, and devilish, which produces envy and strife.

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| <p>1 My brethren, be not many masters, knowing that we shall receive the greater condemnation.</p> <p>2 For in many things we offend all. If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man, and able also to bridle the whole body.</p> <p>3 Behold, we put bits in the horses' mouths, that they may obey us; and we turn about their whole body.</p> <p>4 Behold also the ships, which though they be so great, and are driven of fierce winds, yet are they turned about with a very small helm, whithersoever the governor listeth.</p> <p>5 Even so the tongue is a little member, and boasteth great things. Behold, how great a matter a little fire kindleth!</p> | <p>My brethren, be not many masters, knowing that we shall receive the greater condemnation.</p> <p>For in many things we all offend. If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man, and able also to bridle the whole body.</p> <p>We put bits in the horses' mouths, that they may obey us; and we turn about their whole body.</p> <p>See also the ships, which though they be so great, and are driven of fierce winds, yet are they turned about with a very small helm, wherever the governor wills.</p> <p>Even so the tongue is a little member, and boasts great things. See how great a matter a little fire kindles!</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (in-*IK*-wih-tee) — deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin" — the corruption beneath the sinful act. Where "sin" is missing the mark, iniquity is the bent nature underneath. James uses it to describe the whole disordered moral world that the tongue draws its power from.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (*HEL*) — the place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one word — hell — where the original languages use several (Sheol, Hades, Gehenna). Here James uses the word for Gehenna, the Valley of Hinnom near Jerusalem, which was a burning garbage dump and became the picture of fiery, permanent judgment.

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| <p>6 <i>And the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity: so is the tongue among our members, that it defileth the whole body, and setteth on fire the course of nature; and it is set on fire of hell.</i></p> <p>7 <i>For every kind of beasts, and of birds, and of serpents, and of things in the sea, is tamed, and hath been tamed of mankind:</i></p> <p>8 <i>But the tongue can no man tame; it is an unruly evil, full of deadly poison.</i></p> | <p>And the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity; so is the tongue among our members, that it defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature; and it is set on fire of hell.</p> <p>For every kind of beasts, and of birds, and of serpents, and of things in the sea, is tamed, and has been tamed by mankind,</p> <p>but the tongue can no man tame; it is an unruly evil, full of deadly poison.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Similitude** (sim-ILL-ih-tood) — likeness; the image or resemblance of something. James uses this word to remind us that every human being — no matter their status — bears the likeness of God. To curse a person is to curse someone made in God's image. The KJV preserves this distinctive word where modern translations often say simply "likeness."

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| <p>9 <i>Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, which are made after the similitude of God.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Out of the same mouth proceedeth blessing and cursing. My brethren, these things ought not so to be.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Doth a fountain send forth at the same place sweet water and bitter?</i></p> <p>12 <i>Can the fig tree, my brethren, bear olive berries? either a vine, figs? so can no fountain both yield salt water and fresh.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Who is a wise man and endued with knowledge among you? let him shew out of a good conversation his works with meekness of wisdom.</i></p> | <p>Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, who are made after the similitude of God.</p> <p>Out of the same mouth proceeds blessing and cursing. My brethren, these things ought not so to be.</p> <p>Does a fountain send forth at the same place sweet water and bitter?</p> <p>Can the fig tree, my brethren, bear olive berries? Either a vine, figs? So can no fountain both yield salt water and fresh.</p> <p>Who is a wise man and endued with knowledge among You? Let Him show out of a good conversation His works with meekness of wisdom.</p> |
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| 14 | <i>But if ye have bitter envying and strife in your hearts, glory not, and lie not against the truth.</i> | But if You have bitter envying and strife in Your hearts, glory not, and lie not against the truth. |
| 15 | <i>This wisdom descendeth not from above, but is earthly, sensual, devilish.</i> | This wisdom descends not from above, but is earthly, sensual, devilish. |
| 16 | <i>For where envying and strife is, there is confusion and every evil work.</i> | For where envying and strife is, there is confusion and every evil work. |
| 17 | <i>But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be intreated, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality, and without hypocrisy.</i> | But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be entreated, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality, and without hypocrisy. |
| 18 | <i>And the fruit of righteousness is sown in peace of them that make peace.</i> | And the fruit of righteousness is sown in peace of those who make peace. |

Words in this chapter:

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

similitude — A likeness or visible form — used when God appears in a shape or when something resembles something else closely.

Cross-References:

- v1** — 1 Tim 1:7; Luke 12:47-48; 1 Pet 5:3; Matt 23:13; 1 Cor 12:28
- v2** — Jas 1:26; Prov 13:3; 1 Pet 3:10; Matt 12:37; Jas 3:5-6
- v5** — Prov 18:21; Jer 9:3-8; Prov 12:18; Prov 15:2; Ps 17:10
- v6** — Ps 120:2-3; Prov 16:27; Mark 7:15; Matt 15:11-20; Prov 15:1
- v8** — Rom 3:13; Ps 140:3; Ps 55:21; Jas 3:6; Ps 57:4
- v10** — Rom 12:14; 1 Pet 3:9; Ps 50:16-20; 1 Cor 3:3; 1 Tim 5:13
- v13** — Gal 5:23; Jas 3:17; Matt 5:5; Col 3:12; 1 Pet 2:12
- v14** — Jas 3:16; 1 Cor 13:4; Phil 2:3; 1 Cor 3:3; Rom 13:13
- v15** — Jas 3:17; 1 Cor 3:19; Jas 1:17; Phil 3:19; 1 Cor 2:14
- v16** — Jas 3:14; 1 Cor 3:3; 1 Cor 14:33; 1 John 3:12; Gal 5:20
- v17** — Gal 5:22-23; Prov 2:6; 1 Cor 13:4-7; Jas 3:15; Rom 12:9
- v18** — Matt 5:9; Hos 10:12; Phil 1:11; Isa 32:16-17; Gal 6:8

Chapter 4

James identifies the source of quarrels and conflicts as the lusts that war within, and declares that friendship with the world is enmity with God. He calls on the proud to humble themselves before the Lord, warns against speaking evil of one another, and rebukes those who boast about tomorrow, saying their life is but a vapour that appears for a little time and then vanishes away.

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| 1 | <i>From whence come wars and fightings among you? come they not hence, even of your lusts that war in your members?</i> | From where come wars and fightings among you? Come they not from this — even from your lusts that war in your members? |
| 2 | <i>Ye lust, and have not: ye kill, and desire to have, and cannot obtain: ye fight and war, yet ye have not, because ye ask not.</i> | You lust, and have not; you kill, and desire to have, and cannot obtain; you fight and war, yet you have not, because you ask not. |
| 3 | <i>Ye ask, and receive not, because ye ask amiss, that ye may consume it upon your lusts.</i> | You ask, and receive not, because you ask amiss, that you may consume it on your lusts. |
| 4 | <i>Ye adulterers and adulteresses, know ye not that the friendship of the world is enmity with God? whosoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God.</i> | You adulterers and adulteresses, do you not know that the friendship of the world is enmity with God? Whoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God. |
| 5 | <i>Do ye think that the scripture saith in vain, The spirit that dwelleth in us lusteth to envy?</i> | Do you think that the scripture says in vain, "The spirit that dwells in us lusts to envy"? |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve. Grace is not God overlooking sin — it is God freely giving what we have not earned and could never earn. James shows that God gives more grace to the humble precisely because the humble know they have nothing to offer.

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| 6 | <i>But he giveth more grace. Wherefore he saith, God resisteth the proud, but giveth grace unto the humble.</i> | But He gives more grace. Therefore He says, "God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble." |
| 7 | <i>Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.</i> | Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you. |

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| <p>8 <i>Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you. Cleanse your hands, ye sinners; and purify your hearts, ye double minded.</i></p> <p>9 <i>Be afflicted, and mourn, and weep: let your laughter be turned to mourning, and your joy to heaviness.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and he shall lift you up.</i></p> <p>11 <i>Speak not evil one of another, brethren. He that speaketh evil of his brother, and judgeth his brother, speaketh evil of the law, and judgeth the law: but if thou judge the law, thou art not a doer of the law, but a judge.</i></p> <p>12 <i>There is one lawgiver, who is able to save and to destroy: who art thou that judgest another?</i></p> <p>13 <i>Go to now, ye that say, To day or to morrow we will go into such a city, and continue there a year, and buy and sell, and get gain:</i></p> <p>14 <i>Whereas ye know not what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away.</i></p> <p>15 <i>For that ye ought to say, If the Lord will, we shall live, and do this, or that.</i></p> <p>16 <i>But now ye rejoice in your boastings: all such rejoicing is evil.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Therefore to him that knoweth to do good, and doeth it not, to him it is sin.</i></p> | <p>Draw near to God, and He will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, you sinners; and purify your hearts, you doubleminded.</p> <p>Be afflicted, and mourn, and weep; let your laughter be turned to mourning, and your joy to heaviness.</p> <p>Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and He shall lift you up.</p> <p>Speak not evil one of another, brethren. He who speaks evil of his brother, and judges his brother, speaks evil of the law, and judges the law; but if you judge the law, you are not a doer of the law, but a judge.</p> <p>There is one lawgiver, who is able to save and to destroy; who are you that judges another?</p> <p>Come now, you who say, "Today or tomorrow we will go into such a city, and continue there a year, and buy and sell, and get gain";</p> <p>whereas you do not know what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapor, that appears for a little time, and then vanishes away.</p> <p>For you ought to say, "If the Lord will, we shall live, and do this, or that."</p> <p>But now you rejoice in your boastings; all such rejoicing is evil.</p> <p>Therefore to him that knows to do good, and does it not, to him it is sin.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Pet 2:11; Gal 5:17; Rom 7:23; Jas 1:14; Rom 8:7
- v2 — John 16:24; Matt 7:7-8; Jas 1:5; Luke 11:9-13; John 4:10
- v3 — 1 John 5:14; 1 John 3:22; Jas 1:6-7; Jas 4:1; Prov 15:8
- v4 — 1 John 2:15-16; Rom 8:7; John 15:19; Matt 6:24; Gal 1:10
- v5 — 2 Cor 6:16; 1 Cor 6:19; Num 11:29; Titus 3:3
- v6 — Matt 23:12; Prov 3:34; 1 Pet 5:5; Prov 18:12; Ps 138:6
- v7 — 1 Pet 5:8-9; Eph 4:27; Eph 6:11-12; 1 Pet 5:6; Luke 4:2-13
- v8 — Ps 145:18; Heb 10:22; Mal 3:7; Zech 1:3; Isa 55:6-7
- v10 — Ps 147:6; Matt 23:12; 1 Pet 5:6; Luke 14:11; Jas 4:6-7
- v14 — 1 Pet 1:24; Ps 39:5; 1 John 2:17; Ps 102:3; Job 7:6-7
- v15 — Prov 19:21; Heb 6:3; Lam 3:37; Acts 18:21; Rom 1:10
- v17 — John 9:41; John 13:17; John 15:22; 2 Pet 2:21; Luke 12:47-48

Chapter 5

James warns the rich that their riches are corrupted and their gold and silver cankered, and that the hire of the labourers they kept back by fraud cries out to the Lord. He urges patience until the coming of the Lord, calls for prayer in affliction and praise in gladness, and declares that the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and that the effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man avails much.

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| 1 | <i>Go to now, ye rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come upon you.</i> | Come now, you rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come on you. |
| 2 | <i>Your riches are corrupted, and your garments are motheaten.</i> | Your riches are corrupted, and your garments are motheaten. |
| 3 | <i>Your gold and silver is cankered; and the rust of them shall be a witness against you, and shall eat your flesh as it were fire. Ye have heaped treasure together for the last days.</i> | Your gold and silver is cankered; and the rust of them shall be a witness against you, and shall eat your flesh as it were fire. You have heaped treasure together for the last days. |

- 4 *Behold, the hire of the labourers who have reaped down your fields, which is of you kept back by fraud, crieth: and the cries of them which have reaped are entered into the ears of the Lord of sabaoth.* The hire of the laborers who have reaped down your fields, which is by you kept back by fraud, cries; and the cries of those who have reaped have entered into the ears of the Lord of sabaoth.
- 5 *Ye have lived in pleasure on the earth, and been wanton; ye have nourished your hearts, as in a day of slaughter.* You have lived in pleasure on the earth, and been wanton; you have nourished your hearts, as in a day of slaughter.
- 6 *Ye have condemned and killed the just; and he doth not resist you.* You have condemned and killed the just; and he does not resist you.
- 7 *Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and latter rain.* Be patient therefore, brethren, to the coming of the Lord. The husbandman waits for the precious fruit of the earth, and has long patience for it, until He receive the early and latter rain.
- 8 *Be ye also patient; stablish your hearts: for the coming of the Lord draweth nigh.* Be also patient; establish your hearts, for the coming of the Lord draws near.
- 9 *Grudge not one against another, brethren, lest ye be condemned: behold, the judge standeth before the door.* Grudge not one against another, brethren, lest you be condemned; the judge stands before the door.
- 10 *Take, my brethren, the prophets, who have spoken in the name of the Lord, for an example of suffering affliction, and of patience.* Take, my brethren, the prophets, who have spoken in the name of the Lord, for an example of suffering affliction, and of patience.
- 11 *Behold, we count them happy which endure. Ye have heard of the patience of Job, and have seen the end of the Lord; that the Lord is very pitiful, and of tender mercy.* We count them happy who endure. You have heard of the patience of Job, and have seen the end of the Lord, that the Lord is very pitiful, and of tender mercy.

- 12 *But above all things, my brethren, swear not, neither by heaven, neither by the earth, neither by any other oath: but let your yea be yea; and your nay, nay; lest ye fall into condemnation.* But above all things, my brethren, swear not, neither by heaven, neither by the earth, neither by any other oath; but let your yes be yes, and your no, no, lest you fall into condemnation.
- 13 *Is any among you afflicted? let him pray. Is any merry? let him sing psalms.* Is any among you afflicted? Let him pray. Is any merry? Let him sing psalms.
- 14 *Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord:* Is any sick among you? Let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord.
- 15 *And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up; and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him.* And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise Him up; and if He have committed sins, they shall be forgiven Him.
- 16 *Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.* Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that you may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man avails much.
- 17 *Elias was a man subject to like passions as we are, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain: and it rained not on the earth by the space of three years and six months.* Elias was a man subject to like passions as we are, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain; and it did not rain on the earth by the space of three years and six months.
- 18 *And he prayed again, and the heaven gave rain, and the earth brought forth her fruit.* And he prayed again, and the heaven gave rain, and the earth brought forth her fruit.
- 19 *Brethren, if any of you do err from the truth, and one convert him;* Brethren, if any of you do err from the truth, and one convert him,

- 20 *Let him know, that he which converteth the sinner from the error of his way shall save a soul from death, and shall hide a multitude of sins.* let him know that he who converts the sinner from the error of his way shall save a soul from death, and shall hide a multitude of sins.

Words in this chapter:

Elijah (*eh-LY-jah*) — A prophet of the northern kingdom who confronted King Ahab and the prophets of Baal — did not die but was taken to heaven in a chariot of fire; his name means 'my God is the LORD.'

Cross-References:

- v1** — Prov 11:28; 1 Tim 6:9-10; Prov 11:4; Jas 1:11; Jer 9:23
v4 — Lev 19:13; Jer 22:13; Deut 24:14-15; Rom 9:29; Mal 3:5
v7 — Heb 12:1-3; Jas 5:8-9; Joel 2:23; Gal 6:9; Deut 11:14
v8 — Jas 5:9; Gal 5:22; Ps 37:7; 1 Pet 4:7; Ps 27:14
v9 — Lev 19:18; 1 Cor 4:5; Jas 4:11; Matt 24:33; Gal 5:14
v11 — Jas 1:12; Ex 34:6; Job 1:21-22; Isa 55:6-7; Matt 10:22
v13 — Ps 50:15; Jonah 2:2; Eph 5:19; Acts 16:24-25; Rev 5:9-14
v15 — 1 John 5:14-16; Jas 5:13; Jas 5:16; Matt 21:21-22; Jas 1:6
v16 — Jer 29:12-13; Prov 15:29; Matt 21:22; Ps 34:15; John 9:31
v17 — 1 Kgs 17:1; Luke 4:25; 1 Kgs 18:1; Rev 11:6; Acts 14:15
v19 — Gal 6:1; Matt 18:15; Jas 5:20; Jude 1:22-23; Ezek 34:16
v20 — 1 Pet 4:8; Prov 10:12; 1 Tim 4:16; Prov 11:30; Rom 11:14

1 Peter

Author: Peter the apostle, with Silvanus (Silas) as his secretary (5:12) — Simon Peter, the fisherman from Galilee who became the chief of the apostles.

Date written: c. AD 62–64, from Rome ("Babylon" in 5:13), shortly before Nero's persecution began.

Written to: Jewish and Gentile Christians scattered throughout northern Asia Minor — Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia (1:1).

Setting: Persecution is mounting. Believers are experiencing social hostility, slander, and official harassment for their faith. Peter writes to help them understand why they suffer, how to endure it, and what hope lies beyond it.

Where this sits historically: Written from Rome (coded as "Babylon" in 5:13) just before or at the outbreak of Nero's persecution following the Great Fire of AD 64.

Contemporaries: Silvanus served as Peter's secretary and Mark was at his side, while Paul ministered between his Roman imprisonments and the Pauline pastoral letters were taking shape.

Big themes:

- A living hope — the resurrection of Christ is the foundation of everything; believers have been "begotten again unto a lively hope" through it (1:3)
- Holiness in exile — believers are "strangers and pilgrims" in this world; their conduct must be distinctly holy among the Gentiles
- Suffering for righteousness — Peter addresses unjust suffering extensively, pointing always to Christ's example; He suffered without retaliating, leaving an example to follow
- Election and priesthood — believers are "a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation" (2:9); the language of Israel's covenant identity is now applied to the church
- Submission — to governing authorities, to masters, in marriage, in the church; the pattern of voluntary submission reflects Christ's own humility

Key passages: 1 Pet 1:3; 1:18–19; 2:9; 2:24; 5:7

How it fits: 1 Peter is the NT's primary letter on suffering — what it means, why it comes to believers, and how to endure it with hope. Written as Nero's persecution was beginning, it was immediately relevant. Its description of the church as a royal priesthood (2:9) has shaped Christian identity for twenty centuries. 2 Peter follows as Peter's final letter, written close to his death.

Chapter 1

Peter writes to the scattered believers, praising God for the living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ and for an inheritance incorruptible, reserved in heaven. He urges them to rejoice even in trials that prove their faith, to be holy in all conduct, and reminds them that they were redeemed not with corruptible things like silver and gold but with the precious blood of Christ.

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| <p>1 <i>Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to the strangers scattered throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,</i></p> <p>2 <i>Elect according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, through sanctification of the Spirit, unto obedience and sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ: Grace unto you, and peace, be multiplied.</i></p> | <p>Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to the strangers scattered throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,</p> <p>elect according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, through sanctification of the Spirit, to obedience and sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ: Grace to You, and peace, be multiplied.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sanctification** (sank-tih-fih-KAY-shun) — *being made holy; the lifelong process of being set apart for God. When God sanctifies you, He sets you apart as His own and makes you more like Christ over time.*

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| <p>3 <i>Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which according to his abundant mercy hath begotten us again unto a lively hope by the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead,</i></p> <p>4 <i>To an inheritance incorruptible, and undefiled, and that fadeth not away, reserved in heaven for you,</i></p> <p>5 <i>Who are kept by the power of God through faith unto salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.</i></p> <p>6 <i>Wherein ye greatly rejoice, though now for a season, if need be, ye are in heaviness through manifold temptations:</i></p> | <p>Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, Who according to His abundant mercy has begotten us again to a lively hope by the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead,</p> <p>to an inheritance incorruptible, and undefiled, and that fades not away, reserved in heaven for You,</p> <p>who are kept by the power of God through faith to salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.</p> <p>Wherein You greatly rejoice, though now for a season, if need be, You are in heaviness through manifold temptations,</p> |
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| <p>7 <i>That the trial of your faith, being much more precious than of gold that perisheth, though it be tried with fire, might be found unto praise and honour and glory at the appearing of Jesus Christ:</i></p> <p>8 <i>Whom having not seen, ye love; in whom, though now ye see him not, yet believing, ye rejoice with joy unspeakable and full of glory:</i></p> <p>9 <i>Receiving the end of your faith, even the salvation of your souls.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Of which salvation the prophets have enquired and searched diligently, who prophesied of the grace that should come unto you:</i></p> <p>11 <i>Searching what, or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them did signify, when it testified beforehand the sufferings of Christ, and the glory that should follow.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Unto whom it was revealed, that not unto themselves, but unto us they did minister the things, which are now reported unto you by them that have preached the gospel unto you with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven; which things the angels desire to look into.</i></p> | <p>that the trial of Your faith, being much more precious than of gold that perishes, though it be tried with fire, might be found to praise and honor and glory at the appearing of Jesus Christ;</p> <p>whom having not seen, You love; in whom, though now You see Him not, yet believing, You rejoice with joy unspeakable and full of glory,</p> <p>receiving the end of Your faith, even the salvation of Your souls.</p> <p>Of which salvation the prophets have inquired and searched diligently, who prophesied of the grace that should come to You,</p> <p>searching what, or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them did signify, when it testified beforehand the sufferings of Christ, and the glory that should follow.</p> <p>To whom it was revealed, that not to themselves, but to us they did minister the things, which are now reported to You by those who have preached the gospel to You with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven; which things the angels desire to look into.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. In the KJV, "Ghost" is the older English word for "Spirit." The Holy Ghost is God Himself, who dwells in every believer.*

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| 13 <i>Wherefore gird up the loins of your mind, be sober, and hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought unto you at the revelation of Jesus Christ;</i> | Therefore gird up the loins of Your mind, be sober, and hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought to You at the revelation of Jesus Christ; |
| 14 <i>As obedient children, not fashioning yourselves according to the former lusts in your ignorance:</i> | as obedient children, not fashioning yourselves according to the former lusts in Your ignorance, |
| 15 <i>But as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation;</i> | but as He who has called you is holy, so be holy in all manner of conversation, |
| 16 <i>Because it is written, Be ye holy; for I am holy.</i> | because it is written, "Be holy, for I am holy." |
| 17 <i>And if ye call on the Father, who without respect of persons judgeth according to every man's work, pass the time of your sojourning here in fear:</i> | And if You call on the Father, who without respect of persons judges according to every man's work, pass the time of your sojourning here in fear, |
| 18 <i>Forasmuch as ye know that ye were not redeemed with corruptible things, as silver and gold, from your vain conversation received by tradition from your fathers;</i> | forasmuch as You know that You were not redeemed with corruptible things, as silver and gold, from Your vain conversation received by tradition from Your fathers, |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redeemed** (rih-DEEMD) — *to buy back, to set free by paying a price. God paid the ultimate price — the blood of His own Son — to purchase your freedom from sin and its penalty.*

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| 19 <i>But with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot:</i> | but with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot, |
| 20 <i>Who verily was foreordained before the foundation of the world, but was manifest in these last times for you,</i> | who truly was foreordained before the foundation of the world, but was manifest in these last times for You, |

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| <p>21 <i>Who by him do believe in God, that raised him up from the dead, and gave him glory; that your faith and hope might be in God.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Seeing ye have purified your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit unto unfeigned love of the brethren, see that ye love one another with a pure heart fervently:</i></p> <p>23 <i>Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever.</i></p> <p>24 <i>For all flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away:</i></p> <p>25 <i>But the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you.</i></p> | <p>who by Him do believe in God, Who raised Him up from the dead, and gave Him glory, that Your faith and hope might be in God.</p> <p>Seeing You have purified Your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit to unfeigned love of the brethren, see that You love one another with a pure heart fervently,</p> <p>being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which lives and abides forever.</p> <p>For "all flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withers, and the flower thereof falls away,</p> <p>but the word of the Lord endures forever." And this is the word which by the gospel is preached to You.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

sanctification — Being made holy — the lifelong process of being set apart for God and growing to look more like Christ.

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Cross-References:

v3 — 1 Pet 1:23; 1 John 5:4; Rom 15:13; Titus 3:4-6; Eph 1:7

v6 — Jas 1:2; 1 Pet 5:10; Rom 12:12; Rom 5:2; Matt 5:12

v7 — Job 23:10; Jas 1:12; Isa 48:10; 1 Pet 4:12; Jas 1:3-4

v8 — John 20:29; 2 Cor 5:7; Rom 15:13; Heb 11:1; John 16:22

v13 — 1 Pet 5:8; Luke 12:35; 1 Pet 4:7; Heb 9:28; 1 Pet 3:15

v15 — Matt 5:48; 2 Cor 7:1; Heb 12:14; Jas 3:13; Eph 5:1-2

v16 — Lev 11:44; Lev 19:2; Lev 20:7

v18 — 1 Cor 6:20; Titus 2:14; 1 Cor 7:23; Ps 49:7-8; Gal 1:4
v19 — 1 John 1:7; 1 Pet 2:22-24; John 1:29; Heb 9:12-14; Rev 5:9
v22 — 1 Tim 1:5; Heb 13:1; Rom 12:9-10; 1 Pet 3:8; John 13:34-35
v23 — 1 Pet 1:3; Heb 4:12; John 1:13; John 6:63; John 3:3
v24 — Isa 40:6-8; Ps 103:15; Jas 4:14; Jas 1:10-11; Ps 37:2

Chapter 2

Peter instructs believers to desire the sincere milk of the word and describes them as living stones built up into a spiritual house, a holy priesthood. He calls them a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, and urges them to submit to every ordinance of man for the Lord's sake, pointing to Christ who suffered for us, leaving us an example that we should follow His steps.

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| 1 | <i>Wherefore laying aside all malice, and all guile, and hypocrisies, and envies, and all evil speakings,</i> | Therefore laying aside all malice, and all guile, and hypocrisies, and envies, and all evil speakings, |
| 2 | <i>As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby:</i> | as newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that You may grow thereby, |
| 3 | <i>If so be ye have tasted that the Lord is gracious.</i> | if so be You have tasted that the Lord is gracious. |
| 4 | <i>To whom coming, as unto a living stone, disallowed indeed of men, but chosen of God, and precious,</i> | To whom coming, as to a living stone, disallowed indeed by men, but chosen by God, and precious, |
| 5 | <i>Ye also, as lively stones, are built up a spiritual house, an holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God by Jesus Christ.</i> | you also, as lively stones, are built up a spiritual house, a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God by Jesus Christ. |
| 6 | <i>Wherefore also it is contained in the scripture, Behold, I lay in Sion a chief corner stone, elect, precious: and he that believeth on him shall not be confounded.</i> | Therefore also it is contained in the scripture, "I lay in Sion a chief corner stone, elect, precious; and He who believes on him shall not be confounded." |
| 7 | <i>Unto you therefore which believe he is precious: but unto them which be disobedient, the stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner,</i> | To You therefore who believe He is precious; but to those who are disobedient, "The stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner," |

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| <p>8 <i>And a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence, even to them which stumble at the word, being disobedient: whereunto also they were appointed.</i></p> <p>9 <i>But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:</i></p> <p>10 <i>Which in time past were not a people, but are now the people of God: which had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy.</i></p> | <p>and "a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence," even to those who stumble at the word, being disobedient; to which also they were appointed.</p> <p>But You are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a peculiar people; that You should show forth the praises of Him who has called You out of darkness into His marvellous light;</p> <p>who in time past were not a people, but are now the people of God; who had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MER-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. When God shows mercy, He does not give us what our sins deserve.

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| <p>11 <i>Dearly beloved, I beseech you as strangers and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts, which war against the soul;</i></p> <p>12 <i>Having your conversation honest among the Gentiles: that, whereas they speak against you as evildoers, they may by your good works, which they shall behold, glorifying God in the day of visitation.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Submit yourselves to every ordinance of man for the Lord's sake: whether it be to the king, as supreme;</i></p> <p>14 <i>Or unto governors, as unto them that are sent by him for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of them that do well.</i></p> | <p>Dearly beloved, I beseech You as strangers and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts, which war against the soul,</p> <p>having Your conversation honest among the Gentiles, that, whereas they speak against You as evildoers, they may by Your good works, which they shall see, glorify God in the day of visitation.</p> <p>Submit yourselves to every ordinance of man for the Lord's sake, whether it be to the king, as supreme,</p> <p>or to governors, as to those who are sent by him for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of those who do well.</p> |
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| 15 <i>For so is the will of God, that with well doing ye may put to silence the ignorance of foolish men:</i> | For so is the will of God, that with well doing you may put to silence the ignorance of foolish men; |
| 16 <i>As free, and not using your liberty for a cloke of maliciousness, but as the servants of God.</i> | as free, and not using your liberty for a cloak of maliciousness, but as the servants of God. |
| 17 <i>Honour all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honour the king.</i> | Honor all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honor the king. |
| 18 <i>Servants, be subject to your masters with all fear; not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward.</i> | Servants, be subject to your masters with all fear; not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward. |
| 19 <i>For this is thankworthy, if a man for conscience toward God endure grief, suffering wrongfully.</i> | For this is thankworthy, if a man for conscience toward God endure grief, suffering wrongfully. |
| 20 <i>For what glory is it, if, when ye be buffeted for your faults, ye shall take it patiently? but if, when ye do well, and suffer for it, ye take it patiently, this is acceptable with God.</i> | For what glory is it, if, when you are buffeted for your faults, you shall take it patiently? But if, when you do well, and suffer for it, you take it patiently, this is acceptable with God. |
| 21 <i>For even hereunto were ye called: because Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that ye should follow his steps:</i> | For even to this were You called, because Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that You should follow His steps; |
| 22 <i>Who did no sin, neither was guile found in his mouth:</i> | who did no sin, neither was guile found in His mouth; |
| 23 <i>Who, when he was reviled, reviled not again; when he suffered, he threatened not; but committed himself to him that judgeth righteously:</i> | who, when He was reviled, reviled not again; when He suffered, He threatened not; but committed Himself to Him who judges righteously; |

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| <p>24 <i>Who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live unto righteousness: by whose stripes ye were healed.</i></p> <p>25 <i>For ye were as sheep going astray; but are now returned unto the Shepherd and Bishop of your souls.</i></p> | <p>who His own self bore our sins in His own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live to righteousness; by whose stripes You were healed.</p> <p>For You were as sheep going astray, but are now returned to the Shepherd and Bishop of Your souls.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Zion (*ZY-on*) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Eph 4:31; Jas 1:21; Jas 4:11; 1 Pet 3:10; Col 3:5-8
- v2 — Heb 5:12-13; Eph 4:15; 2 Pet 3:18; 1 Cor 3:1-2; Mark 10:15
- v5 — Eph 2:20-22; 1 Pet 2:9; 1 Cor 3:9; Rev 5:10; 1 Cor 3:16
- v6 — Isa 28:16; Rom 9:32-33; 1 Pet 2:4; Eph 2:20; Zech 10:4
- v9 — Ex 19:5-6; Deut 7:6; Rev 1:6; Rev 5:10; Isa 61:6
- v11 — 1 John 2:15-17; Gal 5:24; 1 Pet 4:2; Heb 11:13; Rom 8:13
- v12 — 1 Pet 3:16; Matt 5:16; Titus 2:7-8; Phil 2:15-16; 2 Cor 8:21
- v13 — Titus 3:1; Rom 13:1-7; 1 Tim 2:1-2; Luke 20:25; Prov 24:21
- v21 — 1 John 2:6; Matt 16:24; John 13:15; Eph 5:2; 1 John 3:16
- v23 — Isa 53:7; 1 Pet 4:19; Heb 12:3; Ps 37:5; Acts 4:29
- v24 — Isa 53:4-6; Matt 8:17; Rom 6:11; Rev 22:2; 1 John 2:29
- v25 — Isa 53:6; Ezek 34:6; Luke 15:4-6; Acts 20:28; John 10:11-16

Chapter 3

Peter instructs wives to be in subjection to their own husbands, adorning themselves with the hidden man of the heart, and commands husbands to dwell with their wives according to knowledge, giving honour unto the weaker vessel. He teaches that Christ also suffered once for sins, the just for the unjust, that He might bring us to God, and urges believers to be always ready to give an answer for the hope that is in them with meekness and fear.

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| 1 | <i>Likewise, ye wives, be in subjection to your own husbands; that, if any obey not the word, they also may without the word be won by the conversation of the wives;</i> | Likewise, wives, be in subjection to Your own husbands; that, if any obey not the word, they also may without the word be won by the conversation of the wives, |
| 2 | <i>While they behold your chaste conversation coupled with fear.</i> | while they see Your chaste conversation coupled with fear. |
| 3 | <i>Whose adorning let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel;</i> | Whose adorning, let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel, |
| 4 | <i>But let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price.</i> | but let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price. |
| 5 | <i>For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves, being in subjection unto their own husbands:</i> | For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves, being in subjection to their own husbands, |
| 6 | <i>Even as Sara obeyed Abraham, calling him lord: whose daughters ye are, as long as ye do well, and are not afraid with any amazement.</i> | even as Sara obeyed Abraham, calling him lord; whose daughters you are, as long as you do well, and are not afraid with any amazement. |
| 7 | <i>Likewise, ye husbands, dwell with them according to knowledge, giving honour unto the wife, as unto the weaker vessel, and as being heirs together of the grace of life; that your prayers be not hindered.</i> | Likewise, husbands, dwell with them according to knowledge, giving honor to the wife, as to the weaker vessel, and as being heirs together of the grace of life, that your prayers be not hindered. |
| 8 | <i>Finally, be ye all of one mind, having compassion one of another, love as brethren, be pitiful, be courteous:</i> | Finally, be all of one mind, having compassion one of another, love as brethren, be pitiful, be courteous, |

- 9 *Not rendering evil for evil, or railing for railing; but contrariwise blessing; knowing that ye are thereunto called, that ye should inherit a blessing.* not rendering evil for evil, or railing for railing, but contrariwise blessing, knowing that you are to this called, that you should inherit a blessing.
- 10 *For he that will love life, and see good days, let him refrain his tongue from evil, and his lips that they speak no guile:* For "he who will love life, and see good days, let him refrain his tongue from evil, and his lips that they speak no guile;
- 11 *Let him eschew evil, and do good; let him seek peace, and ensue it.* let him eschew evil, and do good; let him seek peace, and pursue it.
- 12 *For the eyes of the Lord are over the righteous, and his ears are open unto their prayers: but the face of the Lord is against them that do evil.* For the eyes of the Lord are over the righteous, and his ears are open to their prayers; but the face of the Lord is against those who do evil."
- 13 *And who is he that will harm you, if ye be followers of that which is good?* And who is he who will harm you, if you be followers of that which is good?
- 14 *But and if ye suffer for righteousness' sake, happy are ye: and be not afraid of their terror, neither be troubled;* But even if you suffer for righteousness' sake, happy are you; and be not afraid of their terror, neither be troubled;
- 15 *But sanctify the Lord God in your hearts: and be ready always to give an answer to every man that asketh you a reason of the hope that is in you with meekness and fear:* but sanctify the Lord God in your hearts, and be ready always to give an answer to every man who asks you a reason of the hope that is in you with meekness and fear,
- 16 *Having a good conscience; that, whereas they speak evil of you, as of evildoers, they may be ashamed that falsely accuse your good conversation in Christ.* having a good conscience, that, whereas they speak evil of You, as of evildoers, they may be ashamed who falsely accuse Your good conversation in Christ.
- 17 *For it is better, if the will of God be so, that ye suffer for well doing, than for evil doing.* For it is better, if the will of God be so, that You suffer for well doing, than for evil doing.

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For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit:
- For Christ also has once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that He might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit,

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Quickened** (KWIK-end) — made alive; spiritually brought from death to life by God. Here it refers to Christ being raised and vivified by the Spirit after His death on the cross.

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By which also he went and preached unto the spirits in prison;
- by which also He went and preached to the spirits in prison,
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Which sometime were disobedient, when once the longsuffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls were saved by water.
- who in time past were disobedient, when once the longsuffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was preparing, in which few, that is, eight souls were saved by water.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. God's longsuffering means He waits and gives people time to repent before His judgment falls.

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The like figure whereunto even baptism doth also now save us (not the putting away of the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience toward God,) by the resurrection of Jesus Christ:
- The like figure to which even baptism does also now save us (not the putting away of the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience toward God), by the resurrection of Jesus Christ,
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Who is gone into heaven, and is on the right hand of God; angels and authorities and powers being made subject unto him.
- who is gone into heaven, and is on the right hand of God; angels and authorities and powers being made subject to Him.

Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

quickened — Made alive — spiritually brought from death to life by God; used for resurrection and spiritual rebirth.

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Sarah (*SAIR-ah*) — Abraham's wife and mother of Isaac — her name means 'princess'; she laughed when told she would bear a son at age 90.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Col 3:18; Eph 5:33; Eph 5:22-24; Titus 2:3-6; 1 Cor 11:3
- v3 — 1 Tim 2:9-10; Rom 12:2; Isa 3:18-24; Titus 2:3-15; Isa 61:10
- v4 — Col 3:12; 1 Sam 16:7; Rom 2:29; Matt 11:29; Titus 3:2
- v7 — Col 3:19; Gen 2:23-24; Matt 19:3-9; Eph 5:25-28; Eph 5:33
- v8 — Rom 12:10; Eph 4:31-5:2; 1 Pet 1:22; Phil 4:8-9; Jas 3:17
- v9 — Rom 12:17; Prov 20:22; Rom 12:14; Rom 12:19-21; 1 Thess 5:15
- v10 — Ps 34:12-16; Jas 1:26; 1 Pet 2:1; 1 Pet 2:22; Rev 14:5
- v12 — Ps 34:15-16; John 9:31; Prov 15:29; Prov 15:3; 2 Chr 7:15
- v13 — Prov 16:7; Rom 8:28; 1 Thess 5:15; 3 John 1:11; Ps 38:20
- v14 — Matt 10:28; 1 Pet 2:19-20; Matt 5:10-12; Isa 41:10-14; Isa 8:12-13
- v15 — Col 4:6; 2 Tim 2:25-26; Luke 21:14-15; 1 Pet 3:2; Matt 10:18-20
- v18 — Heb 9:28; Heb 9:26; 2 Cor 5:21; 1 Pet 4:6; Titus 2:14

Chapter 4

Peter urges believers to arm themselves with the mind of Christ, to cease from sin, and not to think it strange when the fiery trial comes as though something unusual were happening. He teaches that judgment must begin at the house of God, and that those who suffer according to the will of God should commit the keeping of their souls to Him in well doing as unto a faithful Creator.

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| <p>1 <i>Forasmuch then as Christ hath suffered for us in the flesh, arm yourselves likewise with the same mind: for he that hath suffered in the flesh hath ceased from sin;</i></p> | <p>Forasmuch then as Christ has suffered for us in the flesh, arm yourselves likewise with the same mind; for He who has suffered in the flesh has ceased from sin,</p> |
| <p>2 <i>That he no longer should live the rest of his time in the flesh to the lusts of men, but to the will of God.</i></p> | <p>that He no longer should live the rest of His time in the flesh to the lusts of men, but to the will of God.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>For the time past of our life may suffice us to have wrought the will of the Gentiles, when we walked in lasciviousness, lusts, excess of wine, revellings, banquetings, and abominable idolatries:</i></p> | <p>For the time past of our life may suffice us to have wrought the will of the Gentiles, when we walked in lasciviousness, lusts, excess of wine, revellings, banquetings, and abominable idolatries;</p> |

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| 4 | <i>Wherein they think it strange that ye run not with them to the same excess of riot, speaking evil of you:</i> | wherein they think it strange that You run not with them to the same excess of riot, speaking evil of You, |
| 5 | <i>Who shall give account to him that is ready to judge the quick and the dead.</i> | who shall give account to Him who is ready to judge the quick and the dead. |
| 6 | <i>For for this cause was the gospel preached also to them that are dead, that they might be judged according to men in the flesh, but live according to God in the spirit.</i> | For for this cause was the gospel preached also to those who are dead, that they might be judged according to men in the flesh, but live according to God in the spirit. |
| 7 | <i>But the end of all things is at hand: be ye therefore sober, and watch unto prayer.</i> | But the end of all things is at hand; be therefore sober, and watch to prayer. |
| 8 | <i>And above all things have fervent charity among yourselves: for charity shall cover the multitude of sins.</i> | And above all things have fervent charity among yourselves, for charity shall cover the multitude of sins. |
| 9 | <i>Use hospitality one to another without grudging.</i> | Use hospitality one to another without grudging. |
| 10 | <i>As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God.</i> | As every man has received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God. |
| 11 | <i>If any man speak, let him speak as the oracles of God; if any man minister, let him do it as of the ability which God giveth: that God in all things may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom be praise and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.</i> | If any man speak, let Him speak as the oracles of God; if any man minister, let Him do it as of the ability which God gives, that God in all things may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom be praise and dominion forever and ever. Amen. |
| 12 | <i>Beloved, think it not strange concerning the fiery trial which is to try you, as though some strange thing happened unto you:</i> | Beloved, think it not strange concerning the fiery trial which is to try You, as though some strange thing happened to You, |

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| <p>13 <i>But rejoice, inasmuch as ye are partakers of Christ's sufferings; that, when his glory shall be revealed, ye may be glad also with exceeding joy.</i></p> <p>14 <i>If ye be reproached for the name of Christ, happy are ye; for the spirit of glory and of God resteth upon you: on their part he is evil spoken of, but on your part he is glorified.</i></p> <p>15 <i>But let none of you suffer as a murderer, or as a thief, or as an evildoer, or as a busybody in other men's matters.</i></p> <p>16 <i>Yet if any man suffer as a Christian, let him not be ashamed; but let him glorify God on this behalf.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For the time is come that judgment must begin at the house of God: and if it first begin at us, what shall the end be of them that obey not the gospel of God?</i></p> <p>18 <i>And if the righteous scarcely be saved, where shall the ungodly and the sinner appear?</i></p> <p>19 <i>Wherefore let them that suffer according to the will of God commit the keeping of their souls to him in well doing, as unto a faithful Creator.</i></p> | <p>but rejoice, inasmuch as You are partakers of Christ's sufferings, that, when His glory shall be revealed, You may be glad also with exceeding joy.</p> <p>If You be reproached for the name of Christ, happy are You, for the Spirit of glory and of God rests on You; on their part He is evil spoken of, but on Your part He is glorified.</p> <p>But let none of You suffer as a murderer, or as a thief, or as an evildoer, or as a busybody in other men's matters.</p> <p>Yet if any man suffer as a Christian, let Him not be ashamed, but let Him glorify God on this behalf.</p> <p>For the time is come that judgment must begin at the house of God; and if it first begin at us, what shall the end be of those who obey not the gospel of God?</p> <p>And if the righteous scarcely be saved, where shall the ungodly and the sinner appear?</p> <p>Therefore let those who suffer according to the will of God commit the keeping of their souls to Him in well doing, as to a faithful Creator.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

v1 — Gal 5:24; 1 Pet 3:18; Col 3:3-5; Rom 6:11; Gal 2:20

v2 — Eph 4:22-24; 1 Pet 1:14; Eph 6:6; Titus 3:3-8; Rom 6:11
v7 — Jas 5:8-9; 1 Pet 1:13; Luke 21:34; 1 Pet 5:8; 2 Tim 4:5
v8 — Prov 10:12; Col 3:14; Prov 17:9; Jas 5:20; 1 Pet 1:22
v10 — Rom 12:6-8; 1 Cor 12:4-11; 1 Cor 4:1-2; Mark 10:45; Heb 6:10
v11 — 1 Cor 10:31; Eph 6:10; 1 Pet 4:10; Eph 4:29; 1 Cor 12:4
v12 — 2 Tim 3:12; 1 Pet 1:6-7; 1 Pet 5:9; 1 Thess 3:2-4; Dan 11:35
v13 — Rom 8:17; Jas 1:2-3; Rom 5:3; Phil 3:10; 2 Cor 1:7
v16 — 1 Pet 3:17-18; Phil 1:29; 1 Pet 4:19; Jas 1:2-4; Acts 5:41
v17 — Jer 25:29; 2 Thess 1:8; Rom 2:9; Ezek 9:6; 1 Pet 2:8
v18 — Prov 11:31; Ezek 18:24; Luke 23:31; 2 Pet 2:5-6; Jude 1:15
v19 — Ps 37:5; 2 Tim 1:12; 1 Pet 3:17; Ps 138:8; Ps 146:5-6

Chapter 5

Peter exhorts the elders to feed the flock of God willingly, not for dishonest gain, and as examples rather than as lords over those in their charge. He commands all believers to be clothed with humility, to cast all their care on God for He cares for them, and to be sober and vigilant because the devil walks about as a roaring lion seeking whom he may devour.

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| 1 | <i>The elders which are among you I exhort, who am also an elder, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and also a partaker of the glory that shall be revealed:</i> | The elders who are among You I exhort, who am also an elder, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and also a partaker of the glory that shall be revealed: |
| 2 | <i>Feed the flock of God which is among you, taking the oversight thereof, not by constraint, but willingly; not for filthy lucre, but of a ready mind;</i> | Feed the flock of God which is among You, taking the oversight thereof, not by constraint, but willingly; not for filthy lucre, but of a ready mind; |
| 3 | <i>Neither as being lords over God's heritage, but being ensamples to the flock.</i> | neither as being lords over God's heritage, but being examples to the flock. |
| 4 | <i>And when the chief Shepherd shall appear, ye shall receive a crown of glory that fadeth not away.</i> | And when the chief Shepherd shall appear, You shall receive a crown of glory that fades not away. |

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| <p>5 <i>Likewise, ye younger, submit yourselves unto the elder. Yea, all of you be subject one to another, and be clothed with humility: for God resisteth the proud, and giveth grace to the humble.</i></p> | <p>Likewise, you younger, submit yourselves to the elder. Yes, all of you be subject one to another, and be clothed with humility, for God resists the proud, and gives grace to the humble.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn. Grace means God gives us favor and blessing not because we deserve it, but because of His own love and generosity.*

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| <p>6 <i>Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:</i></p> | <p>Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that He may exalt you in due time,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.</i></p> | <p>casting all your care on Him, for He cares for you.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:</i></p> | <p>Be sober, be vigilant, because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walks about, seeking whom he may devour,</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Whom resist steadfast in the faith, knowing that the same afflictions are accomplished in your brethren that are in the world.</i></p> | <p>whom resist steadfast in the faith, knowing that the same afflictions are accomplished in your brethren who are in the world.</p> |
| <p>10 <i>But the God of all grace, who hath called us unto his eternal glory by Christ Jesus, after that ye have suffered a while, make you perfect, stablish, strengthen, settle you.</i></p> | <p>But the God of all grace, who has called us to His eternal glory by Christ Jesus, after You have suffered a while, make You perfect, establish, strengthen, settle You.</p> |
| <p>11 <i>To him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.</i></p> | <p>To Him be glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen.</p> |
| <p>12 <i>By Silvanus, a faithful brother unto you, as I suppose, I have written briefly, exhorting, and testifying that this is the true grace of God wherein ye stand.</i></p> | <p>By Silvanus, a faithful brother to You, as I suppose, I have written briefly, exhorting, and testifying that this is the true grace of God in which You stand.</p> |

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| <p>13 <i>The church that is at Babylon, elected together with you, saluteth you; and so doth Marcus my son.</i></p> <p>14 <i>Greet ye one another with a kiss of charity. Peace be with you all that are in Christ Jesus. Amen.</i></p> | <p>The church that is at Babylon, elected together with You, salutes You; and so does Marcus my son.</p> <p>Greet one another with a kiss of charity. Peace be with you all who are in Christ Jesus. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Luke 24:48; Col 3:3-4; 2 John 1:1-3 John 1:15; Rom 8:17-18; 1 Pet 5:4
- v2** — Titus 1:7; 1 Tim 3:8; Acts 20:26-28; Titus 3:1; 1 Tim 3:3
- v3** — Phil 3:17; Ezek 34:4; 2 Thess 3:9; 2 Cor 1:24; Matt 20:25-26
- v4** — Jas 1:12; 1 Cor 9:25; Isa 40:11; 2 Tim 4:8; 1 John 3:2
- v5** — Jas 4:6; Prov 3:34; Rom 12:10; Eph 5:21; Phil 2:3
- v6** — Jas 4:10; Luke 14:11; Prov 29:23; Matt 23:12; Luke 18:14
- v7** — Ps 55:22; Phil 4:6; Ps 37:5; Ps 56:3-4; Matt 6:25-26
- v8** — Eph 6:11; Jas 4:7; Eph 4:27; Job 2:2; 1 Pet 1:13
- v9** — Jas 4:7; Acts 14:22; Eph 6:11-13; 1 Pet 2:21; 1 Cor 10:13
- v10** — 2 Cor 4:17; 2 Thess 3:3; 1 Pet 1:6-7; Jude 1:24; Ps 138:7
- v12** — Heb 13:22; Acts 11:23; 1 Cor 15:1; 2 Cor 1:19
- v14** — Rom 16:16; Eph 6:23; Rom 8:1

2 Peter

Author: Peter the apostle — the letter explicitly names "Simon Peter, a servant and an apostle of Jesus Christ" (1:1) and claims eyewitness testimony of the Transfiguration (1:16–18). Peter wrote it knowing his death was imminent (1:14).

Date written: c. AD 64–68, shortly before Peter's martyrdom under Nero in Rome.

Written to: The same general audience as 1 Peter, and possibly to specific churches familiar with Paul's letters (3:15–16).

Setting: Peter is nearing death. False teachers have crept into the churches, denying the Lord, mocking the promise of Christ's return, and living licentiously. 2 Peter is his final charge — a warning and an encouragement — written with the urgency of a man who knows he has little time left.

Where this sits historically: Written from Rome under Nero's persecution, in the final months before Peter's own martyrdom (traditionally by upside-down crucifixion) on the Vatican Hill.

Contemporaries: Paul wrote 2 Timothy as his own farewell in this same window, Jude composed his closely parallel warning soon after, and Mark was at hand as Peter's gospel scribe.

Big themes:

- Growth in grace — the letter opens with a call to add to faith: virtue, knowledge, self-control, patience, godliness, brotherly kindness, charity; spiritual stagnation is not neutrality but blindness
- The certain return of Christ — mockers will say "Where is the promise of his coming?" (3:4); Peter answers that God's timing is not delay but patience, and the Day of the LORD will come like a thief
- False teachers — chapter 2 is an extended and vivid warning against false prophets; their character, methods, and judgment are described in detail
- The authority of Scripture — "holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost" (1:21); the divine inspiration of the OT prophetic word is explicitly stated
- The new heavens and new earth — the present heavens and earth will be dissolved by fire; the believer looks for "new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness" (3:13)

Key passages: 2 Pet 1:3–4; 1:20–21; 3:9; 3:13; 3:18

How it fits: 2 Peter is Peter's farewell letter, written in full awareness of his coming death. Its warning about false teachers who twist Scripture (including Paul's letters, 3:16) is directly relevant to every era of church history. Jude draws heavily on 2 Peter, sharing much of its content about false teachers. Together, 2 Peter and Jude are the NT's paired warnings against apostasy.

Chapter 1

Peter urges believers to add to their faith virtue, knowledge, temperance, patience, godliness, brotherly kindness, and charity, so they will never stumble. He affirms that he was an eyewitness of Christ's majesty on the holy mount, and declares that no prophecy of scripture is of any private interpretation, for holy men of God spoke as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.

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Simon Peter, a servant and an apostle of Jesus Christ, to them that have obtained like precious faith with us through the righteousness of God and our Saviour Jesus Christ:
- 2

Grace and peace be multiplied unto you through the knowledge of God, and of Jesus our Lord,
- Simon Peter, a servant and an apostle of Jesus Christ, to those who have obtained like precious faith with us through the righteousness of God and our Saviour Jesus Christ:

Grace and peace be multiplied to You through the knowledge of God, and of Jesus our Lord,

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Grace* (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn. Grace means God gives us favor and blessing not because we deserve it, but because of His own love and generosity.

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According as his divine power hath given unto us all things that pertain unto life and godliness, through the knowledge of him that hath called us to glory and virtue:
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Whereby are given unto us exceeding great and precious promises: that by these ye might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust.
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And beside this, giving all diligence, add to your faith virtue; and to virtue knowledge;
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And to knowledge temperance; and to temperance patience; and to patience godliness;
- according as His divine power has given to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of Him who has called us to glory and virtue,

by which are given to us exceeding great and precious promises, that by these You might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust.

And besides this, giving all diligence, add to Your faith virtue, and to virtue knowledge,

and to knowledge temperance, and to temperance patience, and to patience godliness,

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| <p>7 <i>And to godliness brotherly kindness; and to brotherly kindness charity.</i></p> <p>8 <i>For if these things be in you, and abound, they make you that ye shall neither be barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>9 <i>But he that lacketh these things is blind, and cannot see afar off, and hath forgotten that he was purged from his old sins.</i></p> <p>10 <i>Wherefore the rather, brethren, give diligence to make your calling and election sure: for if ye do these things, ye shall never fall:</i></p> <p>11 <i>For so an entrance shall be ministered unto you abundantly into the everlasting kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.</i></p> <p>12 <i>Wherefore I will not be negligent to put you always in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and be established in the present truth.</i></p> <p>13 <i>Yea, I think it meet, as long as I am in this tabernacle, to stir you up by putting you in remembrance;</i></p> <p>14 <i>Knowing that shortly I must put off this my tabernacle, even as our Lord Jesus Christ hath shewed me.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Moreover I will endeavour that ye may be able after my decease to have these things always in remembrance.</i></p> | <p>and to godliness brotherly kindness, and to brotherly kindness charity.</p> <p>For if these things be in You, and abound, they make You that You shall neither be barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.</p> <p>But He who lacks these things is blind, and cannot see afar off, and has forgotten that He was purged from His old sins.</p> <p>Therefore the rather, brethren, give diligence to make Your calling and election sure; for if You do these things, You shall never fall.</p> <p>For so an entrance shall be ministered to You abundantly into the everlasting kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.</p> <p>Therefore I will not be negligent to put You always in remembrance of these things, though You know them, and be established in the present truth.</p> <p>Yes, I think it fitting, as long as I am in this tabernacle, to stir You up by putting You in remembrance, knowing that shortly I must put off this my tabernacle, even as our Lord Jesus Christ has shown me.</p> <p>Moreover I will endeavor that You may be able after my decease to have these things always in remembrance.</p> |
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| <p>16 <i>For we have not followed cunningly devised fables, when we made known unto you the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but were eyewitnesses of his majesty.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For he received from God the Father honour and glory, when there came such a voice to him from the excellent glory, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And this voice which came from heaven we heard, when we were with him in the holy mount.</i></p> <p>19 <i>We have also a more sure word of prophecy; whereunto ye do well that ye take heed, as unto a light that shineth in a dark place, until the day dawn, and the day star arise in your hearts:</i></p> <p>20 <i>Knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation.</i></p> <p>21 <i>For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.</i></p> | <p>For we have not followed cunningly devised fables, when we made known to You the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but were eyewitnesses of His majesty.</p> <p>For He received from God the Father honor and glory, when there came such a voice to Him from the excellent glory, "This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased."</p> <p>And this voice which came from heaven we heard, when we were with Him in the holy mount.</p> <p>We have also a more sure word of prophecy, to which You do well that You take heed, as to a light that shines in a dark place, until the day dawn, and the day star arise in Your hearts;</p> <p>knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation.</p> <p>For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man, but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — *the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. In the KJV, "Ghost" is the older English word for "Spirit." The Holy Ghost is God Himself, who dwells in every believer.*

Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v2 — 2 Pet 3:18; John 17:3; Phil 3:8; 1 Pet 1:2; Num 6:24-26
- v3 — 1 Pet 5:10; 2 Tim 1:9; Rom 8:28-30; 1 Cor 3:21-23; Ps 84:11
- v4 — Eph 4:23-24; Ezek 36:25-27; 2 Cor 3:18; Col 3:10; Heb 12:10
- v5 — Phil 4:8; Prov 4:23; 2 Pet 3:18; 2 Pet 1:2-3; Heb 6:11
- v6 — Heb 10:36; Rom 5:3-4; Luke 21:19; 2 Pet 1:3; Heb 12:1
- v7 — Heb 13:1; Rom 12:10; 1 Thess 3:12; Col 3:14; John 13:34-35
- v8 — Titus 3:14; John 15:2; Heb 6:12; Col 3:16; Phil 1:9
- v10 — 2 Pet 3:17; Luke 6:47-49; Heb 6:11; 1 John 3:19-21; Ps 121:3
- v16 — 1 John 4:14; John 1:14; 1 Tim 1:4; 1 John 1:1-3; 1 Cor 2:4
- v17 — Mark 9:7; Matt 17:5; Matt 3:17; Luke 3:22; Luke 9:34-35
- v19 — Isa 9:2; Rev 22:16; Ps 119:105; John 5:39; 2 Cor 4:4-6
- v21 — 2 Tim 3:15-17; 2 Sam 23:2; 1 Pet 1:11; Luke 1:70; Acts 1:16

Chapter 2

Peter warns that false teachers will bring in damnable heresies, even denying the Lord that bought them, and many will follow their destructive ways. He cites God's judgment on the fallen angels, the ancient world through the flood, and Sodom and Gomorrah as proof that the Lord knows how to deliver the godly out of temptations and to reserve the unjust unto the day of judgment to be punished.

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| 1 <i>But there were false prophets also among the people, even as there shall be false teachers among you, who privily shall bring in damnable heresies, even denying the Lord that bought them, and bring upon themselves swift destruction.</i> | But there were false prophets also among the people, even as there shall be false teachers among you, who privily shall bring in damnable heresies, even denying the Lord who bought them, and bring on themselves swift destruction. |
| 2 <i>And many shall follow their pernicious ways; by reason of whom the way of truth shall be evil spoken of.</i> | And many shall follow their pernicious ways, by reason of whom the way of truth shall be evil spoken of. |

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| <p>3 <i>And through covetousness shall they with feigned words make merchandise of you: whose judgment now of a long time lingereth not, and their damnation slumbereth not.</i></p> | <p>And through covetousness shall they with feigned words make merchandise of you, whose judgment now of a long time lingers not, and their damnation slumbers not.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Damnation** (dam-NAY-shun) — God's final judgment against sin; eternal separation from God. When the Bible speaks of damnation, it means the judgment of those who reject God — a real and terrible consequence.

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| <p>4 <i>For if God spared not the angels that sinned, but cast them down to hell, and delivered them into chains of darkness, to be reserved unto judgment;</i></p> | <p>For if God spared not the angels that sinned, but cast them down to hell, and delivered them into chains of darkness, to be reserved to judgment;</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And spared not the old world, but saved Noah the eighth person, a preacher of righteousness, bringing in the flood upon the world of the ungodly;</i></p> | <p>and spared not the old world, but saved Noah the eighth person, a preacher of righteousness, bringing in the flood on the world of the ungodly;</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Hell** (HEL) — the place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses one word — "hell" — for the Hebrew Sheol and the Greek Hades and Gehenna. It is a real place of divine judgment.

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| <p>6 <i>And turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrha into ashes condemned them with an overthrow, making them an ensample unto those that after should live ungodly;</i></p> | <p>and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrha into ashes condemned them with an overthrow, making them an example to those who after should live ungodly,</p> |
| <p>7 <i>And delivered just Lot, vexed with the filthy conversation of the wicked:</i></p> | <p>and delivered just Lot, vexed with the filthy conversation of the wicked</p> |
| <p>8 <i>(For that righteous man dwelling among them, in seeing and hearing, vexed his righteous soul from day to day with their unlawful deeds;)</i></p> | <p>(for that righteous man dwelling among them, in seeing and hearing, vexed his righteous soul from day to day with their unlawful deeds);</p> |

- 9 *The Lord knoweth how to deliver the godly out of temptations, and to reserve the unjust unto the day of judgment to be punished:* the Lord knows how to deliver the godly out of temptations, and to reserve the unjust to the day of judgment to be punished;
- 10 *But chiefly them that walk after the flesh in the lust of uncleanness, and despise government. Presumptuous are they, selfwilled, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignities.* but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of uncleanness, and despise government. Presumptuous are they, selfwilled; they are not afraid to speak evil of dignities.
- 11 *Whereas angels, which are greater in power and might, bring not railing accusation against them before the Lord.* Whereas angels, who are greater in power and might, bring not railing accusation against them before the Lord.
- 12 *But these, as natural brute beasts, made to be taken and destroyed, speak evil of the things that they understand not; and shall utterly perish in their own corruption;* But these, as natural brute beasts, made to be taken and destroyed, speak evil of the things that they understand not, and shall utterly perish in their own corruption,
- 13 *And shall receive the reward of unrighteousness, as they that count it pleasure to riot in the day time. Spots they are and blemishes, sporting themselves with their own deceivings while they feast with you;* and shall receive the reward of unrighteousness, as those who count it pleasure to riot in the day time. Spots they are and blemishes, sporting themselves with their own deceivings while they feast with you,
- 14 *Having eyes full of adultery, and that cannot cease from sin; beguiling unstable souls: an heart they have exercised with covetous practices; cursed children:* having eyes full of adultery, and that cannot cease from sin; beguiling unstable souls; a heart they have exercised with covetous practices; cursed children,
- 15 *Which have forsaken the right way, and are gone astray, following the way of Balaam the son of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness;* who have forsaken the right way, and are gone astray, following the way of Balaam the son of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness,

- 16 *But was rebuked for his iniquity: the dumb ass speaking with man's voice forbad the madness of the prophet.* but was rebuked for his iniquity; the dumb ass speaking with man's voice forbade the madness of the prophet.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Iniquity** (ih-NIK-wih-tee) — *deep, twisted wrongdoing; stronger than "sin."* Iniquity is the corruption beneath the sinful act — the rot at the root that drives a person to rebel against God.

- 17 *These are wells without water, clouds that are carried with a tempest; to whom the mist of darkness is reserved for ever.* These are wells without water, clouds that are carried with a tempest, to whom the mist of darkness is reserved forever.
- 18 *For when they speak great swelling words of vanity, they allure through the lusts of the flesh, through much wantonness, those that were clean escaped from them who live in error.* For when they speak great swelling words of vanity, they allure through the lusts of the flesh, through much wantonness, those who were clean escaped from those who live in error.
- 19 *While they promise them liberty, they themselves are the servants of corruption: for of whom a man is overcome, of the same is he brought in bondage.* While they promise them liberty, they themselves are the servants of corruption; for by whom a man is overcome, of the same is he brought in bondage.
- 20 *For if after they have escaped the pollutions of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again entangled therein, and overcome, the latter end is worse with them than the beginning.* For if after they have escaped the pollutions of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again entangled therein, and overcome, the latter end is worse with them than the beginning.
- 21 *For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them.* For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered to them.

- 22 *But it is happened unto them according to the true proverb, The dog is turned to his own vomit again; and the sow that was washed to her wallowing in the mire.* But it is happened to them according to the true proverb, "The dog is turned to His own vomit again," and, "The sow that was washed to her wallowing in the mire."

Words in this chapter:

damnation — God's final judgment against sin — eternal separation from God; the sentence passed on unrepentant sinners.

conversation — Conduct or way of life — in the KJV, 'conversation' almost never means talking; it means behavior and manner of living.

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Lot (*LOT*) — Abraham's nephew — he chose the fertile Jordan valley near Sodom; later rescued from Sodom's destruction by the angels; ancestor of Moab and Ammon.

Noah (*NO-ah*) — The righteous man God chose to preserve humanity and the animals through the Flood — he built the ark at God's command; his name means 'rest' or 'comfort.'

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 7:15; Jude 1:4; Deut 13:1-3; 2 Tim 4:3; Matt 24:11
- v3 — 2 Cor 2:17; Deut 32:35; Rom 16:18; 1 Thess 2:5; Jude 1:15
- v4 — Jude 1:6; Matt 25:41; Rom 8:32; Rev 20:1-3; Rev 12:7-9
- v5 — Heb 11:7; 2 Pet 3:6; Jude 1:14-15; Luke 17:26-27
- v6 — Jude 1:7; Luke 17:28-30; Deut 29:23; Num 26:10; Gen 19:24-25
- v9 — Ps 34:15-19; 1 Cor 10:13; Rev 3:10; 2 Tim 3:12; Jude 1:14-15
- v10 — Jude 1:16; Jude 1:10; Ex 22:28; Jude 1:18; 2 Pet 3:3
- v14 — 2 Pet 2:3; 2 Pet 2:18; Eph 2:3; Rom 16:18; 2 Pet 3:16
- v15 — Rev 2:14; Jude 1:11; Deut 23:4-5; Num 22:5-7; Num 31:16
- v19 — John 8:34; Rom 6:16-22; Gal 5:13; 1 Pet 2:16; Gal 5:1
- v20 — Heb 10:26-27; Heb 6:4-8; Phil 3:19; Luke 11:24-26; Deut 32:29
- v21 — Ezek 18:24; Heb 6:4-6; Jas 4:17; Ezek 3:20; Luke 12:47

Chapter 3

Peter warns that scoffers will come in the last days, asking where is the promise of Christ's coming, but declares that the Lord is not slack concerning His promise — one day is with the Lord as a thousand years. He teaches that the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night, the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the earth and its works shall be burned up,

so believers should live in holiness as they look for new heavens and a new earth wherein dwells righteousness.

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| 1 <i>This second epistle, beloved, I now write unto you; in both which I stir up your pure minds by way of remembrance:</i> | This second epistle, beloved, I now write to You; in both which I stir up Your pure minds by way of remembrance, |
| 2 <i>That ye may be mindful of the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets, and of the commandment of us the apostles of the Lord and Saviour:</i> | that You may be mindful of the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets, and of the commandment of us the apostles of the Lord and Saviour, |
| 3 <i>Knowing this first, that there shall come in the last days scoffers, walking after their own lusts,</i> | knowing this first, that there shall come in the last days scoffers, walking after their own lusts, |
| 4 <i>And saying, Where is the promise of his coming? for since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation.</i> | and saying, "Where is the promise of His coming? For since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation." |
| 5 <i>For this they willingly are ignorant of, that by the word of God the heavens were of old, and the earth standing out of the water and in the water:</i> | For this they willingly are ignorant of, that by the word of God the heavens were of old, and the earth standing out of the water and in the water, |
| 6 <i>Whereby the world that then was, being overflowed with water, perished:</i> | by which the world that then was, being overflowed with water, perished. |
| 7 <i>But the heavens and the earth, which are now, by the same word are kept in store, reserved unto fire against the day of judgment and perdition of ungodly men.</i> | But the heavens and the earth, which are now, by the same word are kept in store, reserved to fire against the day of judgment and perdition of ungodly men. |
| 8 <i>But, beloved, be not ignorant of this one thing, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.</i> | But, beloved, be not ignorant of this one thing, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. |

- 9 *The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance.* The Lord is not slack concerning His promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering toward us, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Longsuffering** (LONG-suf-er-ing) — patient with people who are difficult; God's slowness to anger. God's longsuffering means He holds back His judgment and gives people time to turn to Him in repentance.

- 10 *But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night; in the which the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat, the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up.* But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night, in which the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat; the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up.
- 11 *Seeing then that all these things shall be dissolved, what manner of persons ought ye to be in all holy conversation and godliness,* Seeing then that all these things shall be dissolved, what manner of persons ought You to be in all holy conversation and godliness,
- 12 *Looking for and hasting unto the coming of the day of God, wherein the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat?* looking for and hasting to the coming of the day of God, in which the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat?
- 13 *Nevertheless we, according to his promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness.* Nevertheless we, according to His promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, in which dwells righteousness.
- 14 *Wherefore, beloved, seeing that ye look for such things, be diligent that ye may be found of him in peace, without spot, and blameless.* Therefore, beloved, seeing that You look for such things, be diligent that You may be found of Him in peace, without spot, and blameless.

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| <p>15 <i>And account that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given unto him hath written unto you;</i></p> <p>16 <i>As also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things; in which are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction.</i></p> <p>17 <i>Ye therefore, beloved, seeing ye know these things before, beware lest ye also, being led away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own steadfastness.</i></p> <p>18 <i>But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To him be glory both now and for ever. Amen.</i></p> | <p>And account that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given to him has written to you,</p> <p>as also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things, in which are some things hard to be understood, which those who are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, to their own destruction.</p> <p>You therefore, beloved, seeing you know these things before, beware lest you also, being led away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own steadfastness.</p> <p>But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To Him be glory both now and forever. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

longsuffering — Patient endurance with difficult people — God's slowness to anger, not because sin doesn't matter but because He is patient.

Cross-References:

- v4** — Jer 17:15; Mal 2:17; Luke 12:45; Jer 5:12-13; Isa 5:18-19
v5 — Heb 11:3; Ps 24:2; Gen 1:9; Gen 1:6; Ps 136:6
v7 — 2 Pet 3:10; Isa 51:6; 2 Pet 3:12; Rev 21:1; Matt 24:35
v8 — Ps 90:4
v9 — 1 Tim 2:4; Rom 2:4; Ps 86:15; Hab 2:3; Isa 30:18
v10 — Rev 21:1; Matt 24:35; 2 Pet 3:7; Rev 16:15; Isa 51:6
v11 — 1 Pet 1:15; Phil 1:27; 1 Pet 2:12; 2 Pet 3:12; 1 Tim 6:11
v12 — 2 Pet 3:10; Isa 34:4; Mic 1:4; Titus 2:13; Ps 50:3
v13 — Isa 65:17; Rev 21:1; Isa 66:22; Rev 21:27
v14 — 1 Thess 5:23; 1 Thess 3:13; Phil 1:10; 1 Cor 15:58; 1 John 3:3
v15 — Rom 2:4; 2 Pet 3:9; 1 Tim 1:16; 1 Pet 3:20; Jas 3:17

v18 — Col 1:10; Eph 4:15; 1 Pet 2:2; Col 3:10; Phil 3:8

1 John

Author: John the apostle — the same author as the Gospel of John and Revelation; the letter's vocabulary, themes, and style are unmistakably Johannine, though the author does not name himself.

Date written: c. AD 85–95, from Ephesus, late in John's life — contemporary with the Gospel of John and Revelation.

Written to: A broad circle of churches, probably in Asia Minor, where John exercised his final decades of ministry.

Setting: A proto-Gnostic teaching has arisen — likely an early form of Docetism — claiming that Jesus did not come "in the flesh" (that is, that the Christ was a spiritual being who only appeared to have a body). Those who held this view had left the congregations (2:19). John writes to confirm true believers and expose the error.

Where this sits historically: Written late in the reign of Domitian (AD 81–96), a generation after the destruction of Jerusalem, when emperor-worship and early gnostic teaching were both pressing on the churches of Asia Minor.

Contemporaries: John was the last surviving apostle, composing 2 John, 3 John, and Revelation in the same window, while Cerinthus and other proto-gnostic teachers were active in Ephesus.

Big themes:

- The Incarnation as non-negotiable — "that which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life" (1:1); physical, historical, bodily reality is the test of truth

- God is light — walking in the light means honest fellowship with God and with one another; confessing sin keeps that fellowship open

- God is love — chapter 4's sustained meditation on divine love is the NT's richest; "God is love" (4:8, 16) is one of Scripture's most quoted and most abused statements

- The Comma Johanneum — 5:7–8 contains the explicit Trinitarian statement: "there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one"

- Tests of genuine faith — the letter repeatedly offers tests: do you obey the commandments? Do you love the brothers? Do you confess that Jesus is the Christ come in the flesh?

Key passages: 1 John 1:9; 2:2; 3:1; 4:8; 5:7; 5:13

How it fits: 1 John is the pastoral companion to the Gospel of John — the Gospel asks "Do you believe?", the epistle asks "How do you know your faith is real?" Together they are the fullest NT exploration of what it means to know God. The Comma Johanneum (5:7) is the clearest explicit Trinitarian statement in the NT and belongs to the TR text this edition follows.

Chapter 1

John declares that he and the apostles are eyewitnesses of the Word of life, which was from the beginning, and that their message is that God is light and in Him is no darkness at all. He teaches that if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus Christ His Son cleanses us from all sin.

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| 1 <i>That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life;</i> | What was from the beginning, what we have heard, what we have seen with our own eyes, what we have looked at and touched with our hands — this is what we proclaim concerning the Word of life. |
| 2 <i>(For the life was manifested, and we have seen it, and bear witness, and shew unto you that eternal life, which was with the Father, and was manifested unto us;)</i> | The life was revealed to us. We have seen it and testify to it, and we declare to You the eternal life which was with the Father and was revealed to us. |
| 3 <i>That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you, that ye also may have fellowship with us: and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ.</i> | We declare to You what we have seen and heard, so that You also may have fellowship with us. And our fellowship is with the Father and with His Son, Jesus Christ. |
| 4 <i>And these things write we unto you, that your joy may be full.</i> | We write this to make our joy complete. |
| 5 <i>This then is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all.</i> | This is the message we have heard from Him and declare to You: God is light; in Him there is no darkness at all. |
| 6 <i>If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth:</i> | If we claim to have fellowship with Him and yet walk in the darkness, we lie and do not live out the truth. |
| 7 <i>But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.</i> | But if we walk in the light, as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin. |

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| 8 | <i>If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.</i> | If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves and the truth is not in us. |
| 9 | <i>If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.</i> | If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and cleanse us from all unrighteousness. |
| 10 | <i>If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.</i> | If we claim we have not sinned, we make Him out to be a liar and His word is not in us. |

Words in this chapter:

fellowship (*FEL-oh-ship*) — sharing in common life with God and with other believers; walking together in the light

propitiation (*proh-PISH-ee-AY-shun*) — the sacrifice that satisfies God's just anger against sin

Cross-References:

v1 — Acts 4:20; John 20:27; 1 John 4:14; John 1:1-18; Luke 24:39

v2 — John 1:4; 1 John 5:20; 1 Tim 3:16; John 17:3; Titus 1:2

v3 — 1 Cor 1:9; John 17:3; John 17:21; Acts 4:20; Phil 2:1

v4 — John 15:11; John 16:24; 2 John 1:12; 2 Cor 1:24; Hab 3:17-18

v5 — John 8:12; Jas 1:17; Isa 60:19; Ps 27:1; John 1:9

v6 — 1 John 4:20; 1 John 2:4; John 3:19-21; Prov 4:18-19; John 8:12

v7 — Eph 5:8; Rom 13:12; Rev 1:5; Eph 1:7; Rev 7:14

v8 — Rom 3:23; Eccl 7:20; Jas 3:2; Isa 53:6; 1 John 2:4

v9 — Ps 32:5; Prov 28:13; Jer 33:8; Ps 51:2-5; 1 John 1:7

v10 — 1 John 1:8; 1 John 5:10; Ps 130:3; 1 John 2:4; 2 John 1:2

Chapter 2

John writes that if anyone sins, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous, and He is the propitiation for our sins and for the sins of the whole world. He warns against loving the world, for all that is in the world — the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life — is not of the Father, and he identifies the antichrist spirit already at work in those who deny that Jesus is the Christ.

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| <p>1 <i>My little children, these things write I unto you, that ye sin not. And if any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous:</i></p> <p>2 <i>And he is the propitiation for our sins: and not for ours only, but also for the sins of the whole world.</i></p> | <p>My dear children, I write this to You so that You will not sin. But if anybody does sin, we have one who speaks to the Father in our defense — Jesus Christ, the Righteous One.</p> <p>He is the propitiation for our sins, and not for ours only but also for the sins of the whole world.</p> |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Propitiation** (proh-PISH-ee-AY-shun) — *the sacrifice that satisfies God's just anger against sin. When the Bible says Jesus is our propitiation, it means He took the punishment we deserved so that God's wrath against our sin was fully paid.*

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| <p>3 <i>And hereby we do know that we know him, if we keep his commandments.</i></p> <p>4 <i>He that saith, I know him, and keepeth not his commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him.</i></p> <p>5 <i>But whoso keepeth his word, in him verily is the love of God perfected: hereby know we that we are in him.</i></p> <p>6 <i>He that saith he abideth in him ought himself also so to walk, even as he walked.</i></p> <p>7 <i>Brethren, I write no new commandment unto you, but an old commandment which ye had from the beginning. The old commandment is the word which ye have heard from the beginning.</i></p> <p>8 <i>Again, a new commandment I write unto you, which thing is true in him and in you: because the darkness is past, and the true light now shineth.</i></p> | <p>We know that we have come to know Him if we keep His commandments.</p> <p>Whoever says, "I know him," but does not keep his commandments is a liar, and the truth is not in that person.</p> <p>But if anyone obeys his word, love for God is truly made complete in them. This is how we know we are in Him.</p> <p>Whoever claims to live in him must live as Jesus did.</p> <p>Dear friends, I am not writing a new command to You, but an old command which You have had from the beginning. This old command is the message You have heard.</p> <p>Yet I am writing You a new command. Its truth is seen in Him and in You, because the darkness is passing and the true light is already shining.</p> |
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- 9 *He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness even until now.* Anyone who claims to be in the light but hates a brother or sister is still in the darkness.
- 10 *He that loveth his brother abideth in the light, and there is none occasion of stumbling in him.* Anyone who loves their brother and sister lives in the light, and there is nothing in them to make them stumble.
- 11 *But he that hateth his brother is in darkness, and walketh in darkness, and knoweth not whither he goeth, because that darkness hath blinded his eyes.* But anyone who hates a brother or sister is in the darkness and walks in the darkness. They do not know where they are going, because the darkness has blinded them.
- 12 *I write unto you, little children, because your sins are forgiven you for his name's sake.* I am writing to You, dear children, because Your sins have been forgiven on account of His name.
- 13 *I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, young men, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father.* I am writing to You, fathers, because You know Him who is from the beginning. I am writing to You, young men, because You have overcome the evil one. I am writing to You, dear children, because You have known the Father.
- 14 *I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, young men, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.* I write to You, fathers, because You know Him who is from the beginning. I write to You, young men, because You are strong, and the word of God lives in You, and You have overcome the evil one.
- 15 *Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world. If any man love the world, the love of the Father is not in him.* Do not love the world or anything in the world. If anyone loves the world, love for the Father is not in them.

- 16 *For all that is in the world, the lust of the flesh, and the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life, is not of the Father, but is of the world.* For everything in the world — the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life — comes not from the Father but from the world.
- 17 *And the world passeth away, and the lust thereof: but he that doeth the will of God abideth for ever.* The world and its desires pass away, but whoever does the will of God lives forever.
- 18 *Little children, it is the last time: and as ye have heard that antichrist shall come, even now are there many antichrists; whereby we know that it is the last time.* Dear children, this is the last hour; and as You have heard that the antichrist is coming, even now many antichrists have come. This is how we know it is the last hour.
- 19 *They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would no doubt have continued with us: but they went out, that they might be made manifest that they were not all of us.* They went out from us, but they did not really belong to us. For if they had belonged to us, they would have remained with us. But their going showed that none of them belonged to us.
- 20 *But ye have an unction from the Holy One, and ye know all things.* But You have an anointing from the Holy One, and all of You know the truth.
- 21 *I have not written unto you because ye know not the truth, but because ye know it, and that no lie is of the truth.* I do not write to You because You do not know the truth, but because You do know it and because no lie comes from the truth.
- 22 *Who is a liar but he that denieth that Jesus is the Christ? He is antichrist, that denieth the Father and the Son.* Who is the liar? It is whoever denies that Jesus is the Christ. Such a person is the antichrist — denying the Father and the Son.
- 23 *Whosoever denieth the Son, the same hath not the Father: (but) he that acknowledgeth the Son hath the Father also.* No one who denies the Son has the Father. Whoever acknowledges the Son has the Father also.

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| <p>24 <i>Let that therefore abide in you, which ye have heard from the beginning. If that which ye have heard from the beginning shall remain in you, ye also shall continue in the Son, and in the Father.</i></p> <p>25 <i>And this is the promise that he hath promised us, even eternal life.</i></p> <p>26 <i>These things have I written unto you concerning them that seduce you.</i></p> <p>27 <i>But the anointing which ye have received of him abideth in you, and ye need not that any man teach you: but as the same anointing teacheth you of all things, and is truth, and is no lie, and even as it hath taught you, ye shall abide in him.</i></p> <p>28 <i>And now, little children, abide in him; that, when he shall appear, we may have confidence, and not be ashamed before him at his coming.</i></p> <p>29 <i>If ye know that he is righteous, ye know that every one that doeth righteousness is born of him.</i></p> | <p>As for You, see that what You have heard from the beginning remains in You. If it does, You also will remain in the Son and in the Father.</p> <p>And this is what He promised us — eternal life.</p> <p>I am writing these things to You about those who are trying to lead You astray.</p> <p>As for You, the anointing You received from Him remains in You, and You do not need anyone to teach you. But as his anointing teaches you about all things and as that anointing is real, not counterfeit — just as it has taught You, remain in Him.</p> <p>And now, dear children, continue in Him, so that when He appears we may be confident and unashamed before Him at His coming.</p> <p>If You know that He is righteous, You know that everyone who does what is right has been born of Him.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

propitiation — The sacrifice that satisfies God's just anger against sin — Christ took the punishment we deserved so God's wrath was fully paid.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Tim 2:5; Rom 8:34; John 14:6; 1 John 1:8-10; Heb 7:24-26
v2 — 1 John 4:14; 1 Pet 3:18; 1 John 4:10; John 1:29; 1 Pet 2:24
v3 — John 14:15; John 15:10; 1 John 5:3; Luke 6:46; 1 John 4:13
v6 — 1 Pet 2:21; John 13:15; 1 Cor 11:1; 1 John 3:6; John 15:4-6
v8 — Eph 5:8; Rom 13:12; John 13:34; John 8:12; 2 Cor 4:4-6

v15 — Jas 4:4; Rom 12:2; Matt 6:24; Col 3:1-2; Luke 16:13
 v16 — Rom 13:14; Gal 5:17; Ps 119:36-37; Gen 3:6; Prov 27:20
 v17 — Matt 24:35; 1 Cor 7:31; Rom 12:2; 1 Pet 4:2; Heb 10:36
 v18 — 1 John 4:3; 2 John 1:7; Matt 24:24; 1 John 2:22; Matt 24:5
 v20 — John 14:26; 1 John 2:27; 2 Cor 1:21-22; Isa 61:1; Ps 23:5
 v27 — John 14:26; 1 John 2:20-21; 1 Cor 2:13; John 16:13; Jer 31:33-34
 v28 — 1 John 4:17; Mark 8:38; 1 John 3:2; 1 Thess 3:13; 1 John 3:21

Chapter 3

John marvels at the love the Father has bestowed on us, that we should be called the sons of God, and declares that when Christ appears we shall be like Him, for we shall see Him as He is. He teaches that whoever is born of God does not practice sin, and that we should love one another not in word only but in deed and in truth, for hereby we know that we are of the truth.

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| 1 | <i>Behold, what manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called the sons of God: therefore the world knoweth us not, because it knew him not.</i> | See what manner of love the Father has bestowed on us, that we should be called the sons of God; therefore the world knows us not, because it knew Him not. |
| 2 | <i>Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is.</i> | Dear friends, now we are children of God, and what we will be has not yet been made known. But we know that when Christ appears, we shall be like Him, for we shall see Him as He is. |
| 3 | <i>And every man that hath this hope in him purifieth himself, even as he is pure.</i> | All who have this hope in Him purify themselves, just as He is pure. |
| 4 | <i>Whosoever committeth sin transgresseth also the law: for sin is the transgression of the law.</i> | Everyone who sins breaks the law. In fact, sin is lawlessness. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — crossing the line that God set; breaking a specific command. Transgression is not just a mistake — it is a willful act of going beyond the boundary God has drawn.

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| 5 | <i>And ye know that he was manifested to take away our sins; and in him is no sin.</i> | But You know that He appeared so that He might take away our sins. And in Him is no sin. |
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| <p>6 <i>Whosoever abideth in him sinneth not: whosoever sinneth hath not seen him, neither known him.</i></p> | No one who lives in him keeps on sinning. No one who continues to sin has either seen him or known Him. |
| <p>7 <i>Little children, let no man deceive you: he that doeth righteousness is righteous, even as he is righteous.</i></p> | Dear children, do not let anyone lead you astray. The one who does what is right is righteous, just as He is righteous. |
| <p>8 <i>He that committeth sin is of the devil; for the devil sinneth from the beginning. For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that he might destroy the works of the devil.</i></p> | The one who does what is sinful is of the devil, because the devil has been sinning from the beginning. The reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the devil's work. |
| <p>9 <i>Whosoever is born of God doth not commit sin; for his seed remaineth in him: and he cannot sin, because he is born of God.</i></p> | No one who is born of God will continue to sin, because God's seed remains in them. They cannot go on sinning, because they have been born of God. |
| <p>10 <i>In this the children of God are manifest, and the children of the devil: whosoever doeth not righteousness is not of God, neither he that loveth not his brother.</i></p> | This is how we know who the children of God are and who the children of the devil are: Anyone who does not do what is right is not God's child, nor is anyone who does not love their brother and sister. |
| <p>11 <i>For this is the message that ye heard from the beginning, that we should love one another.</i></p> | For this is the message you heard from the beginning: We should love one another. |
| <p>12 <i>Not as Cain, who was of that wicked one, and slew his brother. And wherefore slew he him? Because his own works were evil, and his brother's righteous.</i></p> | Do not be like Cain, who belonged to the evil one and murdered his brother. And why did he murder him? Because his own actions were evil and his brother's were righteous. |
| <p>13 <i>Marvel not, my brethren, if the world hate you.</i></p> | Do not be surprised, brothers and sisters, if the world hates you. |

- 14 *We know that we have passed from death unto life, because we love the brethren. He that loveth not his brother abideth in death.* We know that we have passed from death to life, because we love each other. Anyone who does not love remains in death.
- 15 *Whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer: and ye know that no murderer hath eternal life abiding in him.* Anyone who hates a brother or sister is a murderer, and you know that no murderer has eternal life living in him.
- 16 *Hereby perceive we the love of God, because he laid down his life for us: and we ought to lay down our lives for the brethren.* This is how we know what love is: Jesus Christ laid down His life for us. And we ought to lay down our lives for our brothers and sisters.
- 17 *But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother have need, and shutteth up his bowels of compassion from him, how dwelleth the love of God in him?* If anyone has material possessions and sees a brother or sister in need but has no pity on them, how can the love of God be in that person?
- 18 *My little children, let us not love in word, neither in tongue; but in deed and in truth.* Dear children, let us not love with words or speech but with actions and in truth.
- 19 *And hereby we know that we are of the truth, and shall assure our hearts before him.* This is how we know that we belong to the truth and how we set our hearts at rest in His presence.
- 20 *For if our heart condemn us, God is greater than our heart, and knoweth all things.* If our hearts condemn us, we know that God is greater than our hearts, and He knows everything.
- 21 *Beloved, if our heart condemn us not, then have we confidence toward God.* Dear friends, if our hearts do not condemn us, we have confidence before God
- 22 *And whatsoever we ask, we receive of him, because we keep his commandments, and do those things that are pleasing in his sight.* And receive from Him anything we ask, because we keep His commandments and do what pleases Him.

- 23

And this is his commandment, That we should believe on the name of his Son Jesus Christ, and love one another, as he gave us commandment.

And this is His command: to believe in the name of His Son, Jesus Christ, and to love one another as He commanded us.
- 24

And he that keepeth his commandments dwelleth in him, and he in him. And hereby we know that he abideth in us, by the Spirit which he hath given us.

The one who keeps God's commands lives in Him, and He in them. And this is how we know that He lives in us: We know it by the Spirit He gave us.

Words in this chapter:

Cain (KAYN) — Adam and Eve's firstborn son — he killed his brother Abel and was sent away under God's curse to wander the earth.

Cross-References:

- v1 — John 1:12; Gal 3:26; 2 Cor 6:18; Gal 4:5-6; John 3:16
- v2 — Phil 3:21; Col 3:4; 1 Cor 13:12; 2 Cor 3:18; Ps 17:15
- v3 — 2 Cor 7:1; 1 John 2:6; 2 Pet 3:14; Matt 5:48; Heb 12:14
- v4 — 1 John 5:17; Rom 3:20; Rom 4:15; Num 15:31; 2 Cor 12:21
- v6 — 3 John 1:11; 1 John 2:4; 1 John 3:9; 1 John 4:8; John 15:4-7
- v8 — Heb 2:14; John 8:44; Col 2:15; John 12:31; John 16:11
- v9 — 1 John 5:18; 1 Pet 1:23; 1 John 5:1; John 1:13; 1 John 2:29
- v16 — 1 John 4:9-11; Eph 5:2; John 13:34; John 3:16; Rom 5:8
- v17 — Heb 13:16; Isa 58:7-10; Deut 15:7-11; 1 John 4:20; Prov 19:17
- v18 — Jas 2:15-16; Rom 12:9; 1 Pet 1:22; Gal 5:13; 1 Cor 13:4-7
- v20 — Ps 139:1-4; Jer 17:10; Heb 4:13; 1 Cor 4:4; 1 John 4:4
- v22 — John 15:7; John 9:31; Matt 21:22; 1 John 5:14; Mark 11:24

Chapter 4

John commands believers to test the spirits, for many false prophets have gone out into the world: every spirit that confesses Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God, and every spirit that does not confess this is the spirit of antichrist. He declares that God is love, that love is of God, and that perfect love casts out fear — we love Him because He first loved us.

- 1

Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God: because many false prophets are gone out into the world.

Dear friends, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God, because many false prophets have gone out into the world.

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| <p>2 <i>Hereby know ye the Spirit of God: Every spirit that confesseth that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God:</i></p> | <p>This is how You can recognize the Spirit of God: Every spirit that acknowledges that Jesus Christ has come in the flesh is from God.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God: and this is that spirit of antichrist, whereof ye have heard that it should come; and even now already is it in the world.</i></p> | <p>And every spirit that confesses not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God; and this is that spirit of antichrist, of which You have heard that it should come, and even now already is it in the world.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Ye are of God, little children, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.</i></p> | <p>You, dear children, are from God and have overcome them, because the One who is in you is greater than the one who is in the world.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>They are of the world: therefore speak they of the world, and the world heareth them.</i></p> | <p>They are from the world and therefore speak from the viewpoint of the world, and the world listens to them.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>We are of God: he that knoweth God heareth us; he that is not of God heareth not us. Hereby know we the spirit of truth, and the spirit of error.</i></p> | <p>We are from God, and whoever knows God listens to us. But whoever is not from God does not listen to us. This is how we recognize the Spirit of truth and the spirit of falsehood.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Beloved, let us love one another: for love is of God; and every one that loveth is born of God, and knoweth God.</i></p> | <p>Dear friends, let us love one another, for love comes from God. Everyone who loves has been born of God and knows God.</p> |
| <p>8 <i>He that loveth not knoweth not God; for God is love.</i></p> | <p>Whoever does not love does not know God, because God is love.</p> |
| <p>9 <i>In this was manifested the love of God toward us, because that God sent his only begotten Son into the world, that we might live through him.</i></p> | <p>This is how God showed His love among us: He sent His only begotten Son into the world that we might live through Him.</p> |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Only Begotten** (OH-nlee beh-GOT-ten) — *the unique, one-of-a-kind Son; Christ is God's Son in a way no one else can be. "Only begotten" does not mean God made Him — it means Jesus shares the very nature of the Father, unlike any other being.*

- 10 *Herein is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son to be the propitiation for our sins.* This is love: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son to be the propitiation for our sins.
- 11 *Beloved, if God so loved us, we ought also to love one another.* Dear friends, since God so loved us, we also ought to love one another.
- 12 *No man hath seen God at any time. If we love one another, God dwelleth in us, and his love is perfected in us.* No one has ever seen God. But if we love one another, God lives in us and His love is made complete in us.
- 13 *Hereby know we that we dwell in him, and he in us, because he hath given us of his Spirit.* This is how we know that we live in Him and He in us: He has given us of His Spirit.
- 14 *And we have seen and do testify that the Father sent the Son to be the Saviour of the world.* And we have seen and testify that the Father has sent His Son to be the Savior of the world.
- 15 *Whosoever shall confess that Jesus is the Son of God, God dwelleth in him, and he in God.* If anyone acknowledges that Jesus is the Son of God, God lives in them and they in God.
- 16 *And we have known and believed the love that God hath to us. God is love; and he that dwelleth in love dwelleth in God, and God in him.* And so we know and rely on the love God has for us. God is love. Whoever lives in love lives in God, and God in them.
- 17 *Herein is our love made perfect, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment: because as he is, so are we in this world.* This is how love is made complete among us so that we will have confidence on the day of judgment: In this world we are like Jesus.
- 18 *There is no fear in love; but perfect love casteth out fear: because fear hath torment. He that feareth is not made perfect in love.* There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear, because fear has to do with punishment. The one who fears is not made perfect in love.
- 19 *We love him, because he first loved us.* We love because He first loved us.

20	<i>If a man say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar: for he that loveth not his brother whom he hath seen, how can he love God whom he hath not seen?</i>	Whoever claims to love God yet hates a brother or sister is a liar. For whoever does not love their brother and sister, whom they have seen, cannot love God, whom they have not seen.
21	<i>And this commandment have we from him, That he who loveth God love his brother also.</i>	And He has given us this command: Anyone who loves God must also love their brother and sister.

Words in this chapter:

only begotten — The unique, one-of-a-kind Son — Christ is God's Son in a way no one else can be; 'begotten' is not about birth but eternal relationship.

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 Thess 5:21; 2 Pet 2:1; 1 Tim 4:1; 2 John 1:7; Prov 14:15
- v4 — Rom 8:31; 1 John 5:4; Rom 8:37; 1 John 4:16; 1 Cor 2:12
- v7 — 1 John 4:20-5:1; 1 John 4:8; 1 Pet 1:22; 1 John 2:10; Gal 5:22
- v8 — 1 John 4:16; 1 John 4:7; Ps 86:15; 2 Cor 13:11; Ps 86:5
- v9 — John 3:16; 1 John 5:11; Rom 8:32; John 6:57; 1 John 4:10
- v10 — Eph 2:4-5; Rom 5:8-10; 1 John 4:19; 1 John 2:2; John 15:16
- v11 — John 15:12-13; Col 3:13; John 13:34; 1 John 3:23; Luke 10:37
- v15 — Rom 10:9; Matt 10:32; 1 John 5:5; 1 John 3:24; 1 John 4:2
- v16 — 1 John 3:24; Ps 36:7-9; 1 John 3:1; 1 John 4:8-10; Ps 18:1-3
- v18 — 2 Tim 1:7; Rom 8:15; 1 John 4:12; Luke 1:74-75; Heb 12:28
- v19 — 1 John 4:10; John 3:16; John 15:16; Titus 3:3-5; 2 Cor 5:14-15
- v20 — 1 John 3:17; 1 John 2:9; 1 John 4:12; 1 John 2:4; 1 John 2:11

Chapter 5

John declares that whoever believes that Jesus is the Christ is born of God, and that this is the victory that overcomes the world — even our faith. He affirms the three that bear record in heaven — the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost — and these three are one, and writes that he has penned these things so that believers may know they have eternal life.

1	<i>Whosoever believeth that Jesus is the Christ is born of God: and every one that loveth him that begat loveth him also that is begotten of him.</i>	Everyone who believes that Jesus is the Christ is born of God, and everyone who loves the father loves His child as well.
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| 2 <i>By this we know that we love the children of God, when we love God, and keep his commandments.</i> | This is how we know that we love the children of God: by loving God and carrying out His commands. |
| 3 <i>For this is the love of God, that we keep his commandments: and his commandments are not grievous.</i> | In fact, this is love for God: to keep His commands. And His commands are not burdensome. |
| 4 <i>For whatsoever is born of God overcometh the world: and this is the victory that overcometh the world, even our faith.</i> | For everyone born of God overcomes the world. This is the victory that has overcome the world, even our faith. |
| 5 <i>Who is he that overcometh the world, but he that believeth that Jesus is the Son of God?</i> | Who is it that overcomes the world? Only the one who believes that Jesus is the Son of God. |
| 6 <i>This is he that came by water and blood, even Jesus Christ; not by water only, but by water and blood. And it is the Spirit that beareth witness, because the Spirit is truth.</i> | This is the One who came by water and blood — Jesus Christ. He did not come by water only, but by water and blood. And it is the Spirit Who testifies, because the Spirit is the truth. |
| 7 <i>For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.</i> | For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one. |
| 8 <i>And there are three that bear witness in earth, the spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one.</i> | And there are three that bear witness in earth, the spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one. |
| 9 <i>If we receive the witness of men, the witness of God is greater: for this is the witness of God which he hath testified of his Son.</i> | We accept human testimony, but God's testimony is greater because it is the testimony of God, which He has given about His Son. |

- 10 *He that believeth on the Son of God hath the witness in himself; he that believeth not God hath made him a liar; because he believeth not the record that God gave of his Son.* Whoever believes in the Son of God accepts this testimony. Whoever does not believe God has made Him out to be a liar, because they have not believed the testimony God has given about His Son.
- 11 *And this is the record, that God hath given to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.* And this is that testimony: God has given us eternal life, and this life is in His Son.
- 12 *He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life.* Whoever has the Son has life. Whoever does not have the Son of God does not have life.
- 13 *These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life, and that ye may believe on the name of the Son of God.* These things have I written to You who believe on the name of the Son of God, that You may know that You have eternal life, and that You may believe on the name of the Son of God.
- 14 *And this is the confidence that we have in him, that, if we ask any thing according to his will, he heareth us:* This is the confidence we have in approaching God: that if we ask anything according to His will, He hears us.
- 15 *And if we know that he hear us, whatsoever we ask, we know that we have the petitions that we desired of him.* And if we know that He hears us — whatever we ask — we know that we have what we asked of Him.
- 16 *If any man see his brother sin a sin which is not unto death, he shall ask, and he shall give him life for them that sin not unto death. There is a sin unto death: I do not say that he shall pray for it.* If You see any brother or sister commit a sin that does not lead to death, You should pray and God will give them life. I refer to those whose sin does not lead to death. There is a sin that leads to death. I am not saying that You should pray about that.
- 17 *All unrighteousness is sin: and there is a sin not unto death.* All wrongdoing is sin, and there is sin that does not lead to death.

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| <p>18 <i>We know that whosoever is born of God sinneth not; but he that is begotten of God keepeth himself, and that wicked one toucheth him not.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And we know that we are of God, and the whole world lieth in wickedness.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And we know that the Son of God is come, and hath given us an understanding, that we may know him that is true, and we are in him that is true, even in his Son Jesus Christ. This is the true God, and eternal life.</i></p> <p>21 <i>Little children, keep yourselves from idols. Amen.</i></p> | <p>We know that anyone born of God does not continue to sin. The One who was born of God keeps them safe, and the evil one cannot harm them.</p> <p>We know that we are children of God, and that the whole world is under the control of the evil one.</p> <p>We know also that the Son of God has come and has given us understanding, so that we may know Him who is true. And we are in Him who is true by being in His Son Jesus Christ. He is the true God and eternal life.</p> <p>Dear children, keep yourselves from idols. Amen.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Holy Ghost — The Holy Spirit — the third Person of the Trinity; KJV consistently uses 'Ghost' where modern translations say 'Spirit.'

Cross-References:

v3 — John 14:15; John 15:10; Deut 7:9; John 14:21-24; 2 John 1:6
v4 — 1 Cor 15:57; 1 John 4:4; John 16:33; 1 John 3:9; 1 John 5:5
v7 — Matt 28:19; 2 Cor 13:14; Acts 5:32; Matt 3:16-17; John 1:1
v11 — Rom 6:23; 1 John 2:25; John 3:36; 1 John 5:20; John 1:4
v12 — John 3:36; John 5:24; John 1:12; 1 Cor 1:30; Mark 16:16
v13 — John 20:31; John 1:12; 1 John 3:23; 2 Pet 1:10-11; John 3:18
v14 — John 14:13; Jer 29:12-13; Jer 33:3; 1 John 3:21-22; John 15:7
v15 — Luke 11:9-10; Mark 11:24; Prov 15:29; 1 John 5:18-20
v16 — Heb 6:4-6; 1 Sam 2:25; Jer 11:14; Mark 3:28-30; Heb 10:26-31
v18 — 1 John 3:9; 1 John 5:4; Jude 1:21; Jude 1:24; 1 John 5:1
v19 — 2 Cor 4:4; 1 John 4:4-6; Eph 2:2; Gal 1:4; Rev 12:9
v20 — John 17:3; Luke 24:45; John 14:9; 1 Tim 3:16; Isa 44:6

2 John

Author: The apostle John — the same author as the Gospel of John, 1 John, and 3 John. He identifies himself only as "the elder," a title fitting his old age and his position as the last surviving apostle and overseer of the churches of Asia Minor.

Date written: c. AD 85–95, from Ephesus, where John spent the final years of his life. The letter is closely connected in time and concern to 1 John and 3 John.

Written to: "The elect lady and her children" — most likely a specific Christian woman and her family, though some readers have understood the phrase as a figurative address to a local church and its members. The companion letter, 3 John, is written to a man named Gaius.

Setting: John writes a brief, urgent note to warn against traveling false teachers — early proto-Gnostic deceivers who denied that Jesus Christ had come in real human flesh. He commands the elect lady not to receive such teachers into her home and not even to greet them, because to welcome them is to share in their evil work. Along the way he rejoices that her children are walking in the truth, and he promises a coming personal visit so that their joy may be full.

Where this sits historically: Written from Ephesus near the end of Domitian's reign, when itinerant teachers carrying gnostic-style christological errors moved between the house churches of Asia Minor.

Contemporaries: John wrote 1 John, 3 John, and Revelation in the same period, while Polycarp and Ignatius — who would soon lead the next generation of churches — were already young men.

Big themes:

- Truth and love walk together — not in tension, but as one Christian path
- The test of true doctrine: confessing that Jesus Christ has come in the flesh
- The duty to refuse hospitality and even greeting to false teachers
- The danger of "going beyond" the doctrine of Christ — those who do not abide in it do not have God
- Joy in seeing the next generation walking in truth

Key passages: 2 John 1:4; 1:7; 1:9; 1:10

How it fits: 2 John is the second shortest book in the New Testament (3 John is shorter by Greek word count). Together with 3 John, it shows the aging apostle John still exercising careful pastoral oversight of the churches and standing watch against the proto-Gnostic christological heresy that was already entering the Christian community. It is a small but vital letter, holding the line on the person of Christ in just thirteen verses.

Chapter 1

John writes to the elect lady and her children, rejoicing that some of them walk in truth, and gives the commandment to love one another. He warns that many deceivers have entered the world who do not confess that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh, and instructs that anyone who does not bring the doctrine of Christ should not be received into the house or given greeting.

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| 1 <i>The elder unto the elect lady and her children, whom I love in the truth; and not I only, but also all they that have known the truth;</i> | From the elder — to the elect lady and her children, whom I love in the truth; and not I only, but also all those who have come to know the truth — |
| 2 <i>For the truth's sake, which dwelleth in us, and shall be with us for ever.</i> | because of the truth that lives in us and will be with us forever. |
| 3 <i>Grace be with you, mercy, and peace, from God the Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love.</i> | Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us from God the Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn. Grace is not a reward for good behavior. It is God freely giving what we could never deserve — forgiveness, life, and standing before Him — all because of Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MER-see) — Kindness given to someone who deserves punishment. When God shows mercy, He does not give us what our sins have earned. Grace gives the good we did not deserve; mercy withholds the wrath we did deserve.

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| 4 <i>I rejoiced greatly that I found of thy children walking in truth, as we have received a commandment from the Father.</i> | It gave me great joy to find some of Your children walking in the truth, just as we received commandment from the Father. |
| 5 <i>And now I beseech thee, lady, not as though I wrote a new commandment unto thee, but that which we had from the beginning, that we love one another.</i> | And now I beseech You, dear lady — not as though I were writing You a new commandment, but the one we have had from the beginning — that we love one another. |
| 6 <i>And this is love, that we walk after his commandments. This is the commandment, That, as ye have heard from the beginning, ye should walk in it.</i> | And this is love: that we walk according to His commandments. This is the commandment, that as You have heard from the beginning, You should walk in it. |

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| 7 | <i>For many deceivers are entered into the world, who confess not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh. This is a deceiver and an antichrist.</i> | For many deceivers have entered into the world, who do not confess that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh. Such a one is a deceiver and an antichrist. |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Antichrist** (AN-tee-krist) — *In John's letters, "antichrist" is a category, not only a single end-times figure. Any teacher who denies that Jesus is the Christ, or who denies that He came in the flesh, is an antichrist. John says many such antichrists have already come (1 John 2:18). The denial of the real, bodily coming of Christ is the mark.*

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| 8 | <i>Look to yourselves, that we lose not those things which we have wrought, but that we receive a full reward.</i> | Watch yourselves, so that we do not lose the things we have worked for, but that we may receive a full reward. |
| 9 | <i>Whosoever transgresseth, and abideth not in the doctrine of Christ, hath not God. He that abideth in the doctrine of Christ, he hath both the Father and the Son.</i> | Whoever goes beyond and does not remain in the doctrine of Christ does not have God. The one who remains in the doctrine of Christ — He has both the Father and the Son. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Transgression** (trans-GRESH-un) — *Crossing the line that God has set; breaking a specific command. Here John speaks of someone who steps beyond the boundaries of Christ's doctrine — going further than what Christ has taught.*

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| 10 | <i>If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine, receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed:</i> | If anyone comes to you and does not bring this doctrine, do not receive Him into Your house, and do not bid Him God speed. |
| 11 | <i>For he that biddeth him God speed is partaker of his evil deeds.</i> | For whoever bids him God speed shares in His evil deeds. |
| 12 | <i>Having many things to write unto you, I would not write with paper and ink: but I trust to come unto you, and speak face to face, that our joy may be full.</i> | I have many things to write to You, but I would rather not use paper and ink. I hope instead to come to You and speak face to face, so that our joy may be full. |
| 13 | <i>The children of thy elect sister greet thee. Amen.</i> | The children of Your elect sister greet You. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

v1 — 1 Tim 2:4; 1 John 3:18; John 8:32; 1 Pet 5:1; 2 John 1:13-3 John 1:15

v2 — 1 John 2:14; 1 John 1:8; 1 John 2:17; 2 Pet 1:12; Col 3:16

v3 — Rom 1:7; 1 John 4:10; 1 Tim 1:2; 1 Tim 1:14

v4 — 3 John 1:3-4; Eph 5:8; Hos 14:9; 1 John 2:6; Eph 5:2

v5 — John 13:34-35; 1 John 3:11; John 15:12; 1 Thess 4:9; 1 John 3:23

v6 — 1 John 5:3; John 15:10; 1 John 2:24; John 14:15; Gal 5:13-14

v7 — 1 John 4:1-3; 1 John 2:26; 1 John 2:18-22; 2 Pet 2:1-3; 1 Tim 3:16

v8 — Heb 10:35; Rev 3:11; 1 Cor 3:14; 1 Cor 3:8; Heb 12:15

v9 — John 7:16-17; Col 3:16; 1 John 2:22-24; 1 John 1:3; John 15:6

v10 — Titus 3:10; Rom 16:17-18; 2 Thess 3:6; 2 Thess 3:14; 2 Tim 3:5-6

v11 — 1 Tim 5:22; Eph 5:11

v12 — 3 John 1:13-14; John 16:12

3 John

Author: The apostle John — the same John who wrote the Gospel of John, 1 John, and 2 John. He calls himself simply "the elder" (v1), a title fitting his old age and his apostolic authority over the churches of Asia Minor. This is the most personal of his three epistles.

Date written: c. AD 85–95, from Ephesus, late in John's life — the same general period as 1 John and 2 John.

Written to: Gaius, a beloved Christian leader. His exact location is unknown — most likely a believer in one of the churches of Asia Minor under John's apostolic care. Gaius is a common name in the NT (Acts 19:29; 20:4; Rom 16:23; 1 Cor 1:14), and this Gaius cannot be certainly identified with any of those others.

Setting: John writes a short personal letter commending Gaius for his hospitality to traveling Christian missionaries — "the brethren" who had gone out for the sake of Christ's name. Word of Gaius's love and faithful service had reached John, and he wants Gaius to keep on receiving such men generously. But there is also a problem. In the same church (or a nearby one) a man named Diotrephes has been rejecting John's authority, slandering John with malicious words, refusing to welcome traveling Christians himself, and even excommunicating those members who would have welcomed them. John writes both to encourage Gaius and to put Diotrephes on notice that John will deal with him personally when he arrives. A third man, Demetrius, is commended by John — probably the very man carrying this letter.

Where this sits historically: Written from Ephesus near the end of Domitian's reign, when itinerant gospel preachers traveled the Roman road network between Asian house churches that depended on local hospitality.

Contemporaries: John composed 1 John, 2 John, and Revelation in this same window, and the network of churches founded by Paul a generation earlier was now under John's aging oversight.

Big themes:

- Hospitality as a Christian duty — receiving traveling believers is partnership in the gospel
- Walking in the truth — the greatest joy of a spiritual father is to hear his children walking in truth
- Truth and love together — Christian love is never separated from doctrinal truth
- Servant-leadership versus self-promotion — Diotrephes "loveth to have the preeminence," which is the opposite of Christ
- Apostolic authority — John as "the elder" still oversees the churches in his old age, even by letter
- Imitating good, not evil — the man who does good is of God; the man who does evil has not seen God

- The power of personal example — Gaius, Diotrephes, and Demetrius are three living pictures of the choice every believer faces

Key passages: 3 John 1:4; 1:7; 1:9; 1:11

How it fits: 3 John is the shortest book in the entire New Testament by Greek word count. Together with 2 John, it shows the aged apostle John exercising real apostolic oversight by letter — answering pastoral problems one congregation at a time. It is a rare snapshot of how the early church handled the daily work of traveling ministry, hospitality, and church discipline. And it is a piercing warning. When a church leader begins to love being first more than he loves the truth, the damage reaches far beyond himself. 3 John holds up Gaius and Demetrius to be imitated, and holds up Diotrephes as a warning to every age of the church.

Chapter 1

John writes to Gaius, praising his faithfulness in showing hospitality to traveling brethren who went forth for Christ's name's sake. He condemns Diotrephes, who loves to have the preeminence and refuses to receive the brethren, and commends Demetrius, who has a good report from all men and from the truth itself.

- 1

The elder unto the wellbeloved Gaius,

whom I love in the truth.
- From the elder — to my dearly loved friend Gaius, whom I love in the truth.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Gaius** (GAY-us) — A common Roman name; this Gaius is a beloved Christian leader receiving the letter. He cannot be certainly identified with the other Gaiuses in the NT (Acts 19:29; 20:4; Rom 16:23; 1 Cor 1:14), but is clearly a man well known to John and faithful in the truth.

- 2

Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth.
- Dear friend, above all else I pray that you may prosper and be in good health — just as your soul is prospering.
- 3

For I rejoiced greatly, when the brethren came and testified of the truth that is in thee, even as thou walkest in the truth.
- I rejoiced greatly when the brethren came and told me about the truth that is in you — how you are walking in the truth.
- 4

I have no greater joy than to hear that my children walk in truth.
- I have no greater joy than this: to hear that my children walk in truth.
- 5

Beloved, thou doest faithfully whatsoever thou doest to the brethren, and to strangers;
- Dear friend, you are acting faithfully in everything you do for the brethren — even when they are strangers to you.

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| <p>6 <i>Which have borne witness of thy charity before the church: whom if thou bring forward on their journey after a godly sort, thou shalt do well:</i></p> | They have testified to your charity before the church. You will do well to send them on their way in a manner worthy of God. |
| <p>7 <i>Because that for his name's sake they went forth, taking nothing of the Gentiles.</i></p> | For they went out for the sake of His name, taking nothing from the Gentiles. |
| <p>8 <i>We therefore ought to receive such, that we might be fellowhelpers to the truth.</i></p> | So we ought to welcome such men, so that we may be fellow workers for the truth. |
| <p>9 <i>I wrote unto the church: but Diotrephes, who loveth to have the preeminence among them, receiveth us not.</i></p> | I wrote to the church, but Diotrephes, who loves to have the preeminence among them, will not receive us. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Diotrephes** (dy-OT-rih-fees) — "nourished by Zeus" — A self-promoting leader in a local church who rejected John's apostolic authority, slandered him with malicious words, refused to welcome traveling Christians, and excommunicated members who did welcome them. His name is preserved in Scripture as a permanent warning against loving the first place more than the truth.

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| <p>10 <i>Wherefore, if I come, I will remember his deeds which he doeth, prating against us with malicious words: and not content therewith, neither doth he himself receive the brethren, and forbiddeth them that would, and casteth them out of the church.</i></p> | So when I come, I will call attention to the things he is doing — chattering against us with malicious words. And not content with that, he refuses to receive the brethren himself, he stops those who would, and he throws them out of the church. |
| <p>11 <i>Beloved, follow not that which is evil, but that which is good. He that doeth good is of God: but he that doeth evil hath not seen God.</i></p> | Dear friend, do not imitate what is evil, but what is good. The one who does good is of God; the one who does evil has not seen God. |
| <p>12 <i>Demetrius hath good report of all men, and of the truth itself: yea, and we also bear record; and ye know that our record is true.</i></p> | Demetrius is well spoken of by everyone — and by the truth itself. We also speak well of him, and you know that our testimony is true. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Demetrius** (dih-MEE-tree-us) — "belonging to Demeter" — A Christian commended by John, probably a traveling minister and most likely the very man carrying this letter to Gaius. His good character was confirmed by the testimony of all who knew him, by the truth itself, and by John's own apostolic word.

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| <p>13 <i>I had many things to write, but I will not with ink and pen write unto thee:</i></p> <p>14 <i>But I trust I shall shortly see thee, and we shall speak face to face. Peace be to thee. Our friends salute thee. Greet the friends by name.</i></p> | <p>I had many things to write to you, but I do not want to write them with pen and ink.</p> <p>I am trusting that I will see you soon, and we will talk face to face. Peace be to you. The friends here send their greetings. Greet the friends there by name.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v1 — 1 John 3:18; Rom 16:23; 1 Cor 1:14; 2 John 1:1-13; Acts 19:29
- v2 — 2 Pet 1:3-9; 2 Pet 3:18; Col 1:4-6; 1 Pet 4:8; Ps 20:1-5
- v3 — 2 John 1:4; 2 John 1:2; 1 Thess 3:6-9; 1 Thess 2:19-20; Ps 119:11
- v4 — Gal 4:19; Prov 23:24; 2 Tim 1:2; 1 Tim 1:2; 2 Kgs 20:3
- v5 — Gal 6:10
- v6 — 1 Thess 2:12; Acts 15:3; Titus 3:13; Phlm 1:5-7
- v7 — 2 Cor 4:5
- v9 — Titus 1:7-16; Luke 22:24-27; Luke 9:48; Matt 23:4-8
- v10 — Isa 66:5
- v11 — Isa 1:16-17; Ps 37:27; Eph 5:1; 1 Pet 3:11; John 3:20
- v12 — 1 Tim 3:7; John 21:24; Acts 10:22; Acts 22:12; John 19:35
- v13 — 2 John 1:12

Jude

Author: Jude (Greek "Judas," the same Hebrew name as Judah) — he names himself in v1 as "the servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James." He is the half-brother of Jesus (Matt 13:55; Mark 6:3). He is not Judas Iscariot, and not the apostle Judas (Thaddaeus).

Date written: Likely c. AD 65–80. The letter is closely related to 2 Peter in content and theme; whether 2 Peter draws on Jude or Jude on 2 Peter is debated, but the two letters fight the same fight.

Written to: A general Christian audience. The letter does not name a specific church but reads as a circular letter to churches threatened by false teachers who had crept in among them.

Setting: Jude had intended to write a different letter — a calmer treatment of "the common salvation." But circumstances forced him to write urgently. False teachers had slipped into the churches, turning the grace of God into a license for sin, denying Christ, defiling the flesh, and despising authority. Jude marshals Old Testament examples (unbelieving Israel in the wilderness, the fallen angels, Sodom and Gomorrha), a prophecy attributed to Enoch, and the warnings of the apostles, to call believers to earnestly contend for the faith once delivered.

Where this sits historically: Written under Nero or in the years following his death (the "year of four emperors," AD 68–69), as proto-gnostic libertinism began infiltrating churches across the empire.

Contemporaries: Jude wrote in close parallel with 2 Peter, while the apostles Peter and Paul had recently been martyred and the Jewish revolt that would destroy Jerusalem was unfolding.

Big themes:

- The faith once for all delivered — apostolic doctrine is fixed and final, not to be revised
- Contending for the faith against false teachers who have crept in unawares
- Warning examples from OT history — God has not let rebellion go unpunished
- The certain judgment of apostates and the preserving power of God over true believers
- Mercy and fear toward those caught in error — pulling them out of the fire
- The doxology of the only wise God our Saviour — glory, majesty, dominion, and power

Key passages: Jude 1:3; 1:14–15; 1:20–21; 1:24–25

How it fits: Jude is a small but ferocious epistle — the NT's strongest single-letter warning against false teachers. Its closing doxology is among the most beloved passages in Scripture. With 2 Peter, it stands as the late apostolic-era warning to a church being infiltrated by libertine heretics who used grace as a cover for sin. The call to "earnestly contend for the faith" has marked every generation of Christians who have stood for the truth against compromise.

Chapter 1

Jude urges believers to earnestly contend for the faith once delivered to the saints, warning that ungodly men have crept into the church who turn the grace of God into lasciviousness. He cites the judgment on Israel in the wilderness, the fallen angels, and Sodom and Gomorrah, and closes with a doxology to Him who is able to keep them from falling and to present them faultless before the presence of His glory with exceeding joy.

- 1

Jude, the servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to them that are sanctified by God the Father, and preserved in Jesus Christ, and called:
- From Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and brother of James — to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and preserved in Jesus Christ:

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Jude** (JOOD) — Greek "Judas," the same Hebrew name as Judah. Brother of James and half-brother of Jesus (Matt 13:55; Mark 6:3). Not Judas Iscariot, and not the apostle Judas (Thaddaeus). He calls himself simply "the servant of Jesus Christ" — leaving aside any claim to family privilege.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **James** (JAYMS) — "James the Just," the brother of Jude and half-brother of Jesus; leader of the Jerusalem church (Acts 15); author of the Epistle of James. Jude identifies himself by this well-known brother rather than by his own relation to the Lord.

- 2

Mercy unto you, and peace, and love, be multiplied.
- May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to You.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Mercy** (MER-see) — kindness given to someone who deserves punishment; God withholding the wrath we have earned. When God shows mercy, He does not give us what our sins deserve.

- 3

Beloved, when I gave all diligence to write unto you of the common salvation, it was needful for me to write unto you, and exhort you that ye should earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints.
- Beloved, I was making every effort to write to You about the salvation we share, when I found it necessary to write to You instead and urge You to earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints.
- 4

For there are certain men crept in unawares, who were before of old ordained to this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ.
- For certain men have crept in unnoticed — men long ago marked out for this condemnation — ungodly men who twist the grace of our God into a license for sin, and who deny the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ.

■ **WORD NOTE — Grace** (GRAYS) — *God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never earn. Grace means God gives us favor and blessing not because we deserve it, but because of His own love and generosity. The false teachers Jude warns against were taking this gift and turning it into an excuse for sin.*

■ **WORD NOTE — Lasciviousness** (luh-SIV-ee-us-ness) — *unrestrained sensual indulgence; shameless wickedness, especially sexual. The false teachers were claiming that God's grace gave them freedom to live however they pleased.*

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| <p>5 <i>I will therefore put you in remembrance, though ye once knew this, how that the Lord, having saved the people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed them that believed not.</i></p> | <p>I want to remind You — though You already know all of this — that the Lord, after saving His people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who did not believe.</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE — Egypt** (EE-jipt) — *The land of Israel's slavery, from which God delivered them through Moses and the ten plagues. Jude's point: even those who came out of Egypt with God's mighty hand on them were destroyed in the wilderness if they refused to believe (1 Cor 10:1–11).*

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| <p>6 <i>And the angels which kept not their first estate, but left their own habitation, he hath reserved in everlasting chains under darkness unto the judgment of the great day.</i></p> | <p>And the angels who did not keep their original position of authority, but abandoned their proper dwelling — He has kept them in everlasting chains under darkness, reserved for the judgment of the great day.</p> |
| <p>7 <i>Even as Sodom and Gomorrha, and the cities about them in like manner, giving themselves over to fornication, and going after strange flesh, are set forth for an example, suffering the vengeance of eternal fire.</i></p> | <p>In the same way, Sodom and Gomorrha and the surrounding cities — which gave themselves over to fornication and went after strange flesh — are set forth as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire.</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE — Sodom and Gomorrha** (SOD-um, guh-MOR-ah) — *The two cities God destroyed by fire and brimstone for their great wickedness, especially their sexual sin (Gen 19). Lot and his family were rescued before the destruction. Throughout Scripture, Sodom and Gomorrha stand as the proverbial example of God's judgment on the wicked.*

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| 8 | Likewise also these filthy dreamers defile the flesh, despise dominion, and speak evil of dignities. | In the same way, these filthy dreamers defile the flesh, reject authority, and speak evil of those in high positions. |
| 9 | Yet Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses, durst not bring against him a railing accusation, but said, The Lord rebuke thee. | Yet even Michael the archangel, when he was contending with the devil and disputing about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring against him a railing accusation, but said, "The Lord rebuke you." |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Michael** (MY-kel) — "Who is like God?" — The archangel, the chief of the heavenly host and the defender of God's people (Dan 10:13, 12:1; Rev 12:7). He is the only angel in Scripture called "the archangel." Jude's point: even Michael would not pronounce his own judgment on the devil but called on the Lord to rebuke him — while these false teachers slander everything they do not understand.

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| 10 | But these speak evil of those things which they know not: and what they know naturally, as brute beasts, in those things they corrupt themselves. | But these men speak evil of things they do not understand; and the things they do understand by instinct — like unreasoning animals — in those very things they corrupt themselves. |
| 11 | Woe unto them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and ran greedily after the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core. | Woe to them! For they have gone the way of Cain, they have run greedily after the error of Balaam for profit, and they have perished in the rebellion of Korah. |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Cain** (KAYN) — Adam and Eve's firstborn; he murdered his brother Abel out of envy because God accepted Abel's offering and rejected his own (Gen 4). A type of the false teacher's selfish rage and hatred of true worship.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Balaam** (BAY-lam) — The hireling prophet of Numbers 22–24, who tried to curse Israel for money. Though God forced him to bless Israel, he later led Israel into sin for profit (Num 31:16). A type of the false teacher's greed.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Korah** (KO-rah) — KJV spells him "Core." The Levite who, with Dathan and Abiram, rebelled against the God-given authority of Moses and Aaron; the earth opened and swallowed him alive (Num 16). A type of the false teacher's defiance of God-given authority.

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| <p>12 <i>These are spots in your feasts of charity, when they feast with you, feeding themselves without fear: clouds they are without water, carried about of winds; trees whose fruit withereth, without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;</i></p> <p>13 <i>Raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, to whom is reserved the blackness of darkness for ever.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints,</i></p> | <p>These men are blemishes at your feasts of charity, feasting with you without any reverence — shepherds feeding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by the winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead and pulled up by the roots; raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.</p> <p>Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied about these men, saying, "The Lord comes with ten thousands of His saints,</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Enoch** (EE-nok) — "Dedicated" — *The seventh generation from Adam (Gen 5:18–24); the man who "walked with God, and he was not; for God took him" — taken into glory without seeing death. Jude quotes a prophecy attributed to him about the Lord's coming judgment.*

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| <p>15 <i>To execute judgment upon all, and to convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken against him.</i></p> <p>16 <i>These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their own lusts; and their mouth speaketh great swelling words, having men's persons in admiration because of advantage.</i></p> <p>17 <i>But, beloved, remember ye the words which were spoken before of the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ;</i></p> | <p>to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him."</p> <p>These men are murmurers and complainers, walking after their own lusts; their mouths speak great swelling words, and they flatter people for the sake of personal gain.</p> <p>But You, beloved, remember the words that were spoken beforehand by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ</p> <p>—</p> |
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| 18 <i>How that they told you there should be mockers in the last time, who should walk after their own ungodly lusts.</i> | how they told You that in the last time there would be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts. |
| 19 <i>These be they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the Spirit.</i> | These are the ones who cause divisions — sensual men, not having the Spirit. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Sensual** (SEN-shoo-ul) — in the KJV's sense, "fleshly," "natural," "worldly" — driven by the appetites of the body rather than the Spirit of God. Not just "sexual," but the whole life of a person who lives only by what the senses crave. These false teachers were natural men, devoid of the Holy Spirit.

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| 20 <i>But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost,</i> | But You, beloved, building yourselves up on Your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost, |
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■ **WORD NOTE** — **Holy Ghost** (HOH-lee GOHST) — the Holy Spirit; the third Person of the Trinity. In the KJV, "Ghost" is the older English word for "Spirit." The Holy Ghost is God Himself, who dwells in every believer.

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| 21 <i>Keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life.</i> | keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life. |
| 22 <i>And of some have compassion, making a difference:</i> | And on some have compassion, making a distinction; |
| 23 <i>And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh.</i> | and others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire — hating even the garment stained by the flesh. |
| 24 <i>Now unto him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy,</i> | Now to Him who is able to keep You from falling, and to present You faultless before the presence of His glory with exceeding joy — |
| 25 <i>To the only wise God our Saviour, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen.</i> | to the only wise God our Saviour, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen. |

Words in this chapter:

Cross-References:

- v3** — 1 Tim 6:12; Phil 1:27; Jude 1:20; Titus 1:4; 2 Tim 1:13
- v4** — 2 Pet 2:1-3; Gal 2:4; 2 Pet 2:10; Titus 1:15-16; 1 Pet 2:16
- v5** — Heb 3:16-4:2; Num 26:64-65; 1 Cor 10:1-12; Ps 106:26; Num 14:22-37
- v6** — 2 Pet 2:4; Matt 25:41; Eph 6:12; Matt 8:29; 2 Pet 2:9
- v9** — Zech 3:2; 2 Pet 2:11; Deut 34:6; Rev 12:7; Dan 12:1
- v14** — Deut 33:2; Ps 50:3-5; Heb 11:5-6; 2 Thess 1:7-8; 1 Thess 3:13
- v18** — 2 Pet 3:3; 2 Tim 4:3; 2 Tim 3:13; 2 Tim 3:1-5; 1 Tim 4:1-2
- v20** — Eph 6:18; Rom 8:26-27; 1 Cor 14:15; Col 2:7; 1 Thess 5:11
- v21** — 1 John 4:16; Heb 9:28; Lam 3:25-26; 2 Pet 3:12; John 15:9-10
- v23** — 1 Tim 4:16; 1 Cor 15:33; Rev 3:4; 2 Cor 7:10-12; 2 Thess 3:14
- v24** — 2 Tim 4:18; Eph 3:20; Col 1:22; John 10:29-30; Heb 13:20-21
- v25** — 1 Tim 1:17; Rev 5:13-14; John 5:44; 1 Pet 5:10-11; Rev 4:9-11

Revelation

Author: John the apostle, exiled on the island of Patmos — the book names its author as "John" four times (1:1, 1:4, 1:9, 22:8); early church testimony from Justin Martyr and Irenaeus onward identifies him as the apostle.

Date written: c. AD 95–96, during the reign of Domitian, who was actively persecuting Christians who refused to worship the emperor.

Written to: Seven specific churches in Asia Minor (Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamos, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, Laodicea), and through them the whole church in every age.

Setting: John is in exile on Patmos for his testimony. The Roman empire demands divine honors for the emperor. Christians who refuse are imprisoned, impoverished, and killed. The churches are under pressure to conform, compromise, or apostatize. John receives a vision of ultimate reality — the throne of God, the Lamb who was slain, and the final defeat of every power that opposes God.

Where this sits historically: Written under Domitian (AD 81–96) at the height of his demand to be addressed as "Dominus et Deus" (Lord and God), with John exiled to the Aegean penal island of Patmos.

Contemporaries: John was the last surviving apostle, having outlived Peter and Paul by some thirty years; he wrote alongside his three epistles, and Clement of Rome would soon address the Corinthian church.

Big themes:

- The sovereignty of God over history — "the Lord God omnipotent reigneth" (19:6); every seal, trumpet, and bowl is opened from the throne; nothing happens outside God's control
- The Lamb who was slain — Jesus appears as a Lamb bearing the marks of slaughter (5:6); His death is the decisive event of history; worship in heaven centers on what He accomplished at the cross
- Letters to seven churches — chapters 2–3 contain Christ's personal assessments of seven real congregations; the commendations and warnings apply to every church in every era
- Judgment on Babylon — Rome (Babylon) and the beast represent every human system that demands what belongs only to God; its fall is certain and complete
- The new creation — chapters 21–22 describe the new Jerusalem descending from heaven; God dwelling with His people; no more death, pain, or curse; the tree of life restored

Key passages: Rev 1:8; 5:9–10; 19:11–16; 20:15; 22:20

How it fits: Revelation is the Bible's final word. It begins where Genesis ends — with a cursed earth — and ends where Genesis began — with God and man in a garden without curse. Every thread of Scripture is gathered: the Lamb of Genesis 22, the Passover of Exodus, the throne of 2 Samuel 7, the new covenant of Jeremiah 31, the dry bones of Ezekiel 37. The last promise is "Even so, come, Lord Jesus."

Chapter 1

John receives the Revelation of Jesus Christ on the island of Patmos and is commanded to write what he sees to the seven churches in Asia. He sees the Son of man standing among seven golden candlesticks, clothed in a garment down to the foot, His countenance like the sun shining in its strength, holding seven stars in His right hand.

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| 1 | <i>The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him, to shew unto his servants things which must shortly come to pass; and he sent and signified it by his angel unto his servant John:</i> | This is the Revelation of Jesus Christ. God gave it to Him to show His servants what must soon take place. He sent it through His angel to His servant John. |
| 2 | <i>Who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ, and of all things that he saw.</i> | John testified to the word of God and to the testimony of Jesus Christ — everything He saw. |
| 3 | <i>Blessed is he that readeth, and they that hear the words of this prophecy, and keep those things which are written therein: for the time is at hand.</i> | Blessed is the one who reads, and blessed are those who hear the words of this prophecy and keep what is written in it. The time is near. |
| 4 | <i>John to the seven churches which are in Asia: Grace be unto you, and peace, from him which is, and which was, and which is to come; and from the seven Spirits which are before his throne;</i> | John to the seven churches in Asia: Grace and peace to You from Him who is, and who was, and who is to come — and from the seven Spirits before His throne. |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Grace** (GRAYS) — God's unearned kindness; a gift we could never deserve or earn. Every letter in the New Testament opens with grace — it is the foundation of everything God does for us in Christ.

- 5 *And from Jesus Christ, who is the faithful witness, and the first begotten of the dead, and the prince of the kings of the earth. Unto him that loved us, and washed us from our sins in his own blood,* And from Jesus Christ — the faithful witness, the firstborn from the dead, the ruler of the kings of the earth. To Him who loved us and washed us from our sins in His own blood.

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Redemption** (reh-DEMP-shun) — to buy back; to set free by paying a price. Jesus washed us from our sins in His own blood — that is the price He paid to redeem us from sin's power and penalty.

- 6 *And hath made us kings and priests unto God and his Father; to him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.* He has made us kings and priests to God His Father. To Him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.
- 7 *Behold, he cometh with clouds; and every eye shall see him, and they also which pierced him: and all kindreds of the earth shall wail because of him. Even so, Amen.* He is coming with clouds, and every eye will see Him — even those who pierced Him. All families of the earth will mourn because of Him. Even so, Amen.
- 8 *I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is, and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty.* "I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending," says the Lord, who is and who was and who is to come — the Almighty.

■ **NAME NOTE** — **John** (JON) — Hebrew Yohanan, "God is gracious" — The apostle and beloved disciple of Jesus, son of Zebedee, who received this vision while exiled on the island of Patmos. He also wrote the Gospel of John and three epistles.

- 9 *I John, who also am your brother, and companion in tribulation, and in the kingdom and patience of Jesus Christ, was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ.* I, John, am your brother and partner in the suffering and kingdom and patient endurance that are in Jesus Christ. I was on the island called Patmos because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus Christ.
- 10 *I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet,* I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day. I heard behind me a loud voice like a trumpet.

- 11 *Saying, I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea.* It said, "I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last." Then it said, "Write in a book what You see, and send it to the seven churches — to Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamos, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and Laodicea."
- 12 *And I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned, I saw seven golden candlesticks;* I turned to see the voice that spoke to me. When I turned, I saw seven golden lampstands.
- 13 *And in the midst of the seven candlesticks one like unto the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle.* In the middle of the lampstands stood one like the Son of Man. He was clothed with a robe reaching to His feet, and a golden sash was wrapped around His chest.
- 14 *His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire;* His head and hair were white as wool — as white as snow. His eyes were like a flame of fire.
- 15 *And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace; and his voice as the sound of many waters.* His feet were like polished bronze, glowing as if refined in a furnace. His voice was like the sound of many waters.
- 16 *And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength.* In His right hand He held seven stars. Out of His mouth came a sharp two-edged sword. His countenance was like the sun shining in full strength.
- 17 *And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me, saying unto me, Fear not; I am the first and the last:* When I saw Him, I fell at His feet as though dead. He laid His right hand on me and said, "Do not be afraid. I am the first and the last."

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I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and have the keys of hell and of death.

"I am the Living One. I was dead, and now I am alive for ever and ever. Amen. I hold the keys of hell and of death."

■ **WORD NOTE** — *Hell (HEL)* — the place of God's eternal judgment for the unrepentant. The KJV uses this one word for the Hebrew Sheol and the Greek Hades and Gehenna. Here in Revelation it refers to the place of the departed under Christ's authority.

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Write the things which thou hast seen, and the things which are, and the things which shall be hereafter;

"Write the things You have seen, the things that are, and the things that will take place after this."
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The mystery of the seven stars which thou sawest in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks. The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches: and the seven candlesticks which thou sawest are the seven churches.

"Here is the mystery of the seven stars You saw in My right hand and the seven golden lampstands: the seven stars are the angels of the seven churches, and the seven lampstands are the seven churches."

Words in this chapter:

countenance — A person's face and its expression — especially the look that shows someone's inner mood, favor, or displeasure.

Ephesus (*EF-eh-sus*) — A major city on the western coast of Asia Minor (modern Turkey) — home to the temple of Diana (Artemis); Paul planted a church here that he led for three years.

Patmos (*PAT-mos*) — A small rocky island in the Aegean Sea — where the apostle John was exiled and received the Revelation from Christ.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 22:16; Rev 22:6; Gal 1:12; Amos 3:7; Dan 2:28-29
- v3** — Luke 11:28; Rev 22:10; Rom 13:11; 1 Pet 4:7; Rev 22:6-7
- v4** — Isa 11:2; John 1:1; Heb 13:8; Ps 90:2; Rev 5:6
- v5** — Ps 89:27; Heb 9:14; 1 John 1:7; Rev 17:14; Col 1:18
- v6** — Rev 5:10; Rev 20:6; Ex 19:6; 1 Pet 2:5-9; Isa 61:6
- v7** — Matt 24:30; Zech 12:10; Dan 7:13; John 19:37; Mark 14:62
- v8** — Isa 44:6; Rev 22:13; Isa 48:12; Isa 43:10; Rev 21:6
- v14** — Dan 10:6; Dan 7:9; Rev 2:18; Rev 19:12; Matt 28:3
- v15** — Ezek 43:2; Dan 10:6; Rev 14:2; Rev 19:6; Rev 2:18
- v16** — Heb 4:12; Rev 2:12; Rev 19:15; Rev 2:16; Eph 6:17

v17 — Isa 44:6; Rev 22:13; Dan 10:8-10; Dan 8:17-18; Isa 41:4
v18 — Rom 6:9; Heb 7:25; Rom 14:8-9; Ps 68:20; Rev 3:7

Chapter 2

Christ dictates letters to four churches: Ephesus, which has left its first love; Smyrna, which will suffer tribulation ten days but must be faithful unto death; Pergamos, which dwells where Satan's seat is but tolerates false teaching; and Thyatira, which suffers the woman Jezebel to teach and seduce His servants.

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| 1 <i>Unto the angel of the church of Ephesus write; These things saith he that holdeth the seven stars in his right hand, who walketh in the midst of the seven golden candlesticks;</i> | "To the angel of the church in Ephesus write: These things are said by the One who holds the seven stars in his right hand, who walks among the seven golden lampstands." |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Ephesus** (EF-eh-sus) — A major city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) and home to one of the most prominent early churches, where Paul ministered for three years. John is believed to have lived there in his later years.

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| 2 <i>I know thy works, and thy labour, and thy patience, and how thou canst not bear them which are evil: and thou hast tried them which say they are apostles, and are not, and hast found them liars:</i> | "I know Your works, Your labor, and Your patient endurance. I know You cannot tolerate evil men. You have tested those who call themselves apostles and are not, and You found them to be liars." |
| 3 <i>And hast borne, and hast patience, and for my name's sake hast laboured, and hast not fainted.</i> | "You have endured and had patience, and for My name's sake You have labored and not grown weary." |
| 4 <i>Nevertheless I have somewhat against thee, because thou hast left thy first love.</i> | "But I have this against You: You have left Your first love." |
| 5 <i>Remember therefore from whence thou art fallen, and repent, and do the first works; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will remove thy candlestick out of his place, except thou repent.</i> | "Remember from where You have fallen. Repent and do the works You did at first. If not, I will come to You and remove Your lampstand from its place — unless You repent." |

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| 6 | <i>But this thou hast, that thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitanes, which I also hate.</i> | <i>"But You have this in Your favor: You hate the deeds of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate."</i> |
| 7 | <i>He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the midst of the paradise of God.</i> | <i>"Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches. To the one who overcomes I will give the right to eat from the tree of life, which is in the paradise of God."</i> |
| 8 | <i>And unto the angel of the church in Smyrna write; These things saith the first and the last, which was dead, and is alive;</i> | <i>"To the angel of the church in Smyrna write: These things are said by the First and the Last, who was dead and came to life."</i> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Smyrna** (SMER-nah) — *A prosperous port city in Asia Minor known for its large Jewish population and fierce opposition to Christianity. The church there faced severe persecution. Modern-day Izmir, Turkey.*

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| 9 | <i>I know thy works, and tribulation, and poverty, (but thou art rich) and I know the blasphemy of them which say they are Jews, and are not, but are the synagogue of Satan.</i> | <i>"I know your works, your tribulation, and your poverty — but you are rich. I know the slander of those who say they are Jews but are not, and are the synagogue of Satan."</i> |
| 10 | <i>Fear none of those things which thou shalt suffer: behold, the devil shall cast some of you into prison, that ye may be tried; and ye shall have tribulation ten days: be thou faithful unto death, and I will give thee a crown of life.</i> | <i>"Do not be afraid of what you are about to suffer. The devil is about to throw some of you into prison to test you, and you will have tribulation for ten days. Be faithful to death, and I will give you the crown of life."</i> |
| 11 | <i>He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; He that overcometh shall not be hurt of the second death.</i> | <i>"Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches. The one who overcomes will not be hurt by the second death."</i> |
| 12 | <i>And to the angel of the church in Pergamos write; These things saith he which hath the sharp sword with two edges;</i> | <i>"To the angel of the church in Pergamos write: These things are said by the One who has the sharp two-edged sword."</i> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Pergamos** (PER-gah-mos) — Also called Pergamum; a powerful city in Asia Minor and seat of Roman provincial authority. It contained a famous altar to Zeus and a major temple of emperor worship.

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| <p>13 <i>I know thy works, and where thou dwellest, even where Satan's seat is: and thou holdest fast my name, and hast not denied my faith, even in those days wherein Antipas was my faithful martyr, who was slain among you, where Satan dwelleth.</i></p> | <p>"I know your works and where you live — where Satan's throne is. You hold fast to My name and have not denied My faith, even in the days of Antipas, My faithful martyr, who was killed among you where Satan lives."</p> |
| <p>14 <i>But I have a few things against thee, because thou hast there them that hold the doctrine of Balaam, who taught Balac to cast a stumblingblock before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed unto idols, and to commit fornication.</i></p> | <p>"But I have a few things against you: you have some there who hold to the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to put a stumbling block before the children of Israel — to eat food sacrificed to idols and to commit fornication."</p> |
| <p>15 <i>So hast thou also them that hold the doctrine of the Nicolaitanes, which thing I hate.</i></p> | <p>"You also have some who hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans in the same way — which I hate."</p> |
| <p>16 <i>Repent; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will fight against them with the sword of my mouth.</i></p> | <p>"Repent. If not, I will come to you quickly and fight against them with the sword of My mouth."</p> |
| <p>17 <i>He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it.</i></p> | <p>"Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches. To the one who overcomes I will give the hidden manna. I will also give Him a white stone, with a new name written on it that no one knows except the one who receives it."</p> |
| <p>18 <i>And unto the angel of the church in Thyatira write; These things saith the Son of God, who hath his eyes like unto a flame of fire, and his feet are like fine brass;</i></p> | <p>"To the angel of the church in Thyatira write: These things are said by the Son of God, Who has eyes like a flame of fire and feet like polished bronze."</p> |

■ **NAME NOTE** — **Thyatira** (THY-ah-TY-rah) — A city in Asia Minor known for its trade guilds, where the businesswoman Lydia came from (Acts 16:14). The church there tolerated a false prophetess called Jezebel.

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| <p>19 <i>I know thy works, and charity, and service, and faith, and thy patience, and thy works; and the last to be more than the first.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Notwithstanding I have a few things against thee, because thou sufferest that woman Jezebel, which calleth herself a prophetess, to teach and to seduce my servants to commit fornication, and to eat things sacrificed unto idols.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And I gave her space to repent of her fornication; and she repented not.</i></p> <p>22 <i>Behold, I will cast her into a bed, and them that commit adultery with her into great tribulation, except they repent of their deeds.</i></p> <p>23 <i>And I will kill her children with death; and all the churches shall know that I am he which searcheth the reins and hearts: and I will give unto every one of you according to your works.</i></p> <p>24 <i>But unto you I say, and unto the rest in Thyatira, as many as have not this doctrine, and which have not known the depths of Satan, as they speak; I will put upon you none other burden.</i></p> <p>25 <i>But that which ye have already hold fast till I come.</i></p> <p>26 <i>And he that overcometh, and keepeth my works unto the end, to him will I give power over the nations:</i></p> | <p>"I know Your works — your love, Your service, Your faith, and Your patient endurance. I know that Your latter works exceed the first."</p> <p>"But I have this against you: you tolerate that woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess, and she teaches and seduces My servants to commit fornication and to eat things sacrificed to idols."</p> <p>"I gave her time to repent, but she refuses to repent of her fornication."</p> <p>"I am going to throw her onto a bed of sickness, and those who commit adultery with her into great tribulation — unless they repent of her deeds."</p> <p>"I will strike her children dead. Then all the churches will know that I am He who searches minds and hearts. I will give to each of you according to your works."</p> <p>"But to the rest of you in Thyatira — all who do not hold this teaching and have not learned what they call 'the deep things of Satan' — I put no other burden on you."</p> <p>"Only hold fast to what you have until I come."</p> <p>"To the one who overcomes and keeps My works to the end, I will give authority over the nations."</p> |
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| 27 | <i>And he shall rule them with a rod of iron; as the vessels of a potter shall they be broken to shivers: even as I received of my Father.</i> | "He will rule them with a rod of iron, as when clay pots are broken in pieces — just as I also received authority from My Father." |
| 28 | <i>And I will give him the morning star.</i> | "And I will give him the morning star." |
| 29 | <i>He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.</i> | "Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches." |

Words in this chapter:

charity — Love that gives itself for others — in 1 Corinthians 13, the KJV word for sacrificial, selfless, godly love.

candlestick — The golden lampstand in the tabernacle — a seven-branched stand of hammered gold that burned pure olive oil and lit the Holy Place; also called the menorah.

Balaam (*BAY-lam*) — A pagan prophet hired by Balak to curse Israel — God turned his curses to blessings; he later advised Israel's enemies to lead Israel into sin.

Balak (*BAY-lak*) — King of Moab who hired Balaam to curse Israel — his name means 'devastator'; he feared Israel after their defeat of the Amorites.

Jezebel (*JEZ-eh-bel*) — Ahab's Phoenician queen — aggressively promoted Baal worship and persecuted the prophets of God; killed Naboth to take his vineyard; eaten by dogs as prophesied.

Cross-References:

- v2** — 1 John 4:1; 2 Pet 2:1-3; 1 Thess 5:21; 2 Cor 11:13-15; Rev 3:8
- v3** — Heb 10:36; Jas 5:7-11; Gal 6:9; Jas 1:3-4; Heb 12:1
- v4** — Matt 24:12-13; Jer 2:2-5; Heb 6:10-11; Phil 1:9; 2 Thess 1:3
- v5** — Rev 3:2-3; Rev 3:19; Rev 2:16; Hos 14:1; Acts 17:30-31
- v7** — Rev 2:17; Rev 2:11; Matt 11:15; Matt 13:43; Rev 13:9
- v9** — Rev 3:9; Jas 2:5-6; 2 Cor 8:9; Rom 9:6; 2 Cor 6:10
- v10** — Jas 1:12; Matt 10:22; Rev 3:10-11; Luke 21:16-19; 1 Pet 5:4
- v11** — Rev 20:6; Rev 20:14; Rev 21:8; Rev 2:7; Rev 2:17
- v14** — Num 31:16; 2 Pet 2:15; Rev 2:20; Num 25:1-3; Acts 15:29
- v17** — Isa 62:2; Isa 65:15; Rev 19:12-13; Rev 3:12-13; Rev 2:7
- v20** — Rev 2:14; 1 Kgs 16:31; 1 Cor 10:18-21; Acts 15:29; Acts 15:20
- v26** — Rev 3:21; Dan 7:27; Rev 2:7; Rev 20:4; Ps 2:8

Chapter 3

Christ dictates letters to three churches: Sardis, which has a name that it lives but is dead; Philadelphia, which has kept His word and will be kept from the hour of temptation that will come upon all the world; and Laodicea, which is lukewarm — neither cold nor hot — and will

be spewed out of His mouth unless it repents.

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| <p>1 And unto the angel of the church in Sardis write; These things saith he that hath the seven Spirits of God, and the seven stars; I know thy works, that thou hast a name that thou livest, and art dead.</p> | <p>"To the angel of the church in Sardis write: These things are said by the One who has the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars. I know Your works — you have a reputation for being alive, but You are dead."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Sardis** (SAR-dis) — The capital city of the ancient kingdom of Lydia, famed for its wealth. The church there had a reputation for being alive but was spiritually dead, complacent and comfortable in its prosperity.

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| <p>2 Be watchful, and strengthen the things which remain, that are ready to die: for I have not found thy works perfect before God.</p> | <p>"Wake up and strengthen what remains, which is about to die. I have not found Your works complete before My God."</p> |
| <p>3 Remember therefore how thou hast received and heard, and hold fast, and repent. If therefore thou shalt not watch, I will come on thee as a thief, and thou shalt not know what hour I will come upon thee.</p> | <p>"Remember what You received and heard. Hold to it and repent. If You do not wake up, I will come like a thief, and You will not know at what hour I will come against You."</p> |
| <p>4 Thou hast a few names even in Sardis which have not defiled their garments; and they shall walk with me in white: for they are worthy.</p> | <p>"Yet You have a few names in Sardis who have not defiled their clothes. They will walk with Me in white, for they are worthy."</p> |
| <p>5 He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.</p> | <p>"The one who overcomes will be dressed in white. I will never blot out His name from the book of life. I will confess His name before My Father and before His angels."</p> |
| <p>6 He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.</p> | <p>"Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches."</p> |

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| <p>7 <i>And to the angel of the church in Philadelphia write; These things saith he that is holy, he that is true, he that hath the key of David, he that openeth, and no man shutteth; and shutteth, and no man openeth;</i></p> | <p>"To the angel of the church in Philadelphia write: These things are said by the One who is holy and true, who has the key of David — who opens and no one shuts, who shuts and no one opens."</p> |
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■ **NAME NOTE** — **Philadelphia** (fil-ah-DEL-fee-ah) — "brotherly love" — A city in Asia Minor lying on the road to the east. The church there is one of only two that receives no rebuke from Christ, praised for keeping His word faithfully despite limited strength.

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| <p>8 <i>I know thy works; behold, I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it: for thou hast a little strength, and hast kept my word, and hast not denied my name.</i></p> | <p>"I know Your works. I have placed before You an open door that no one can shut. You have only a little strength, yet You have kept My word and have not denied My name."</p> |
| <p>9 <i>Behold, I will make them of the synagogue of Satan, which say they are Jews, and are not, but do lie; behold, I will make them to come and worship before thy feet, and to know that I have loved thee.</i></p> | <p>"I will make those of the synagogue of Satan — who say they are Jews but are not, but lie — I will make them come and bow down at your feet and know that I have loved you."</p> |
| <p>10 <i>Because thou hast kept the word of my patience, I also will keep thee from the hour of temptation, which shall come upon all the world, to try them that dwell upon the earth.</i></p> | <p>"Because you have kept My word about patient endurance, I will keep you from the hour of trial that is coming on the whole world, to test those who live on the earth."</p> |
| <p>11 <i>Behold, I come quickly: hold that fast which thou hast, that no man take thy crown.</i></p> | <p>"I am coming soon. Hold fast to what you have, so that no one takes your crown."</p> |

- 12 *Him that overcometh will I make a pillar in the temple of my God, and he shall go no more out: and I will write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, which is new Jerusalem, which cometh down out of heaven from my God: and I will write upon him my new name.* "The one who overcomes I will make a pillar in the temple of My God. He will never leave it. I will write on Him the name of My God and the name of the city of My God — the new Jerusalem, which comes down from heaven from My God — and I will also write on Him My new name."
- 13 *He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.* "Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches."
- 14 *And unto the angel of the church of the Laodiceans write; These things saith the Amen, the faithful and true witness, the beginning of the creation of God;* "To the angel of the church in Laodicea write: These things are said by the Amen, the faithful and true Witness, the beginning of God's creation."
- **NAME NOTE** — **Laodicea** (lay-OD-ih-SEE-ah) — A wealthy city in Asia Minor known for its banking, textile industry, and eye medicine. The church there is the only one that receives no praise — condemned as lukewarm, proud of its wealth but spiritually destitute.
- 15 *I know thy works, that thou art neither cold nor hot: I would thou wert cold or hot.* "I know Your works — you are neither cold nor hot. I wish You were cold or hot."
- 16 *So then because thou art lukewarm, and neither cold nor hot, I will spue thee out of my mouth.* "Because You are lukewarm — neither hot nor cold — I am about to spit You out of my mouth."
- 17 *Because thou sayest, I am rich, and increased with goods, and have need of nothing; and knowest not that thou art wretched, and miserable, and poor, and blind, and naked:* "You say, 'I am rich; I have grown wealthy and need nothing.' But You do not know that You are wretched, miserable, poor, blind, and naked."

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| <p>18 <i>I counsel thee to buy of me gold tried in the fire, that thou mayest be rich; and white raiment, that thou mayest be clothed, and that the shame of thy nakedness do not appear; and anoint thine eyes with eyesalve, that thou mayest see.</i></p> <p>19 <i>As many as I love, I rebuke and chasten: be zealous therefore, and repent.</i></p> <p>20 <i>Behold, I stand at the door, and knock: if any man hear my voice, and open the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me.</i></p> <p>21 <i>To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with my Father in his throne.</i></p> <p>22 <i>He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.</i></p> | <p>"I counsel You to buy from Me gold refined in fire so You can be truly rich, and white clothes to wear so Your shameful nakedness is covered, and eye salve to put on Your eyes so You can see."</p> <p>"Those I love I rebuke and discipline. Be earnest, therefore, and repent."</p> <p>"I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears My voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with Him, and He with Me."</p> <p>"To the one who overcomes I will give the right to sit with Me on My throne, just as I overcame and sat down with My Father on His throne."</p> <p>"Let the one who has an ear listen to what the Spirit says to the churches."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

v3 — Rev 2:5; 2 Pet 3:10; 1 Thess 5:2; Rev 16:15; Matt 24:42-43
v5 — Matt 10:32; Rev 21:27; Luke 12:8; Rev 20:15; Rev 20:12
v7 — Isa 22:22; Matt 16:19; Rev 1:18; Job 12:14; John 14:6
v8 — 1 Cor 16:9; Col 4:3; Rev 3:7; 2 Cor 2:12; Phil 4:13
v10 — 2 Pet 2:9; Rev 14:12; Zech 13:9; Dan 12:10; Rev 2:10
v11 — Jas 1:12; Rev 22:12; Rev 2:10; Rev 2:25; 2 Tim 4:8
v14 — Col 1:15; Rev 1:5; 2 Cor 1:20; Col 1:18; Rev 3:7
v15 — Rom 12:11; Matt 6:24; 1 Kgs 18:21; Jas 1:8; Rev 2:4
v18 — Rev 16:15; 1 Pet 1:7; Isa 55:1; Rev 19:8; Mal 3:3
v19 — Prov 3:11-12; 1 Cor 11:32; Heb 12:5-11; Job 5:17; Rev 2:5
v20 — Luke 12:36-37; Rev 19:9; John 14:21-23; Matt 24:33; Song 5:2-4

v21 — 2 Tim 2:12; Matt 19:28; Rev 2:26-27; John 16:33; Rev 2:7

Chapter 4

John sees a door opened in heaven and a throne set in heaven with One sitting on it, surrounded by twenty-four elders and four living creatures. The living creatures cry "Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come," and the elders cast their crowns before the throne, worshiping Him who lives for ever and ever.

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| <p>1 <i>After this I looked, and, behold, a door was opened in heaven: and the first voice which I heard was as it were of a trumpet talking with me; which said, Come up hither, and I will shew thee things which must be hereafter.</i></p> | <p>After this I looked, and there before me was an open door in heaven. The first voice I had heard — like a trumpet — spoke to me again: "Come up here, and I will show you what must take place after this."</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And immediately I was in the Spirit: and, behold, a throne was set in heaven, and one sat on the throne.</i></p> | <p>At once I was in the Spirit. There before me was a throne in heaven, and Someone was seated on the throne.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And he that sat was to look upon like a jasper and a sardine stone: and there was a rainbow round about the throne, in sight like unto an emerald.</i></p> | <p>The One seated there looked like jasper and carnelian. Around the throne was a rainbow that looked like an emerald.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And round about the throne were four and twenty seats: and upon the seats I saw four and twenty elders sitting, clothed in white raiment; and they had on their heads crowns of gold.</i></p> | <p>Surrounding the throne were twenty-four other thrones, and seated on them were twenty-four elders. They were dressed in white and had golden crowns on their heads.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And out of the throne proceeded lightnings and thunderings and voices: and there were seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.</i></p> | <p>From the throne came flashes of lightning, rumblings, and thunder. Before the throne seven lamps were blazing — these are the seven Spirits of God.</p> |
| <p>6 <i>And before the throne there was a sea of glass like unto crystal: and in the midst of the throne, and round about the throne, were four beasts full of eyes before and behind.</i></p> | <p>Before the throne there was what looked like a sea of glass, clear as crystal. In the center around the throne were four living creatures, covered with eyes in front and behind.</p> |

7	<i>And the first beast was like a lion, and the second beast like a calf, and the third beast had a face as a man, and the fourth beast was like a flying eagle.</i>	The first living creature was like a lion. The second was like a calf. The third had a face like a man. The fourth was like a flying eagle.
8	<i>And the four beasts had each of them six wings about him; and they were full of eyes within: and they rest not day and night, saying, Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come.</i>	Each of the four living creatures had six wings and was covered with eyes all around and inside. Day and night they never stop saying: "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God Almighty, who was, and is, and is to come."
9	<i>And when those beasts give glory and honour and thanks to him that sat on the throne, who liveth for ever and ever,</i>	Whenever the living creatures give glory, honor, and thanks to Him who sits on the throne and lives for ever and ever,
10	<i>The four and twenty elders fall down before him that sat on the throne, and worship him that liveth for ever and ever, and cast their crowns before the throne, saying,</i>	The twenty-four elders fall down before Him who sits on the throne and worship Him who lives for ever and ever. They lay their crowns before the throne and say:
11	<i>Thou art worthy, O Lord, to receive glory and honour and power: for thou hast created all things, and for thy pleasure they are and were created.</i>	"You are worthy, O Lord, to receive glory and honor and power, for You created all things. By Your will they were created and exist."

Words in this chapter:

raiment — Clothing; garments — used throughout the KJV for both everyday clothes and royal dress.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 11:12; Ex 24:12; Rev 1:19; Rev 1:10; Rev 1:1-3
- v2 — Rev 1:10; 1 Kgs 22:19; Isa 6:1; Ezek 3:12-14; Ezek 1:26
- v3 — Ezek 1:28; Gen 9:13-16; Rev 21:11; Rev 10:1; Ezek 28:13
- v4 — Matt 19:28; Rev 11:16; Rev 4:10; Rev 20:4; Rev 7:11
- v5 — Rev 11:19; Rev 8:5; Rev 1:4; Rev 16:17-18; Rev 5:6
- v6 — Rev 15:2; Rev 5:6; Rev 14:3; Rev 4:8-9; Ezek 10:12
- v7 — Ezek 10:14; Ezek 1:10; Ezek 10:21; Dan 7:4; Ezek 1:8

v8 — Isa 6:2-13; Rev 1:8; Heb 13:8; Rev 4:6; Ex 15:11

v9 — Rev 5:13-14; Rev 7:11-12; Rev 10:6; Rev 15:7; Ps 47:8

v10 — Rev 5:8; Rev 19:4; Ps 95:6; Rev 11:16; 1 Chr 29:11-16

v11 — Col 1:16-17; Rev 5:12; Isa 40:28; Prov 16:4; John 1:1-3

Chapter 5

John sees a book sealed with seven seals in the right hand of Him who sits on the throne, and no man in heaven or earth is found worthy to open it. The Lamb who was slain — the Lion of the tribe of Judah — takes the book, and all heaven erupts in worship: "Thou art worthy...for Thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by Thy blood."

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| 1 <i>And I saw in the right hand of him that sat on the throne a book written within and on the backside, sealed with seven seals.</i> | I saw in the right hand of Him who sat on the throne a scroll written on the inside and on the back, sealed with seven seals. |
| 2 <i>And I saw a strong angel proclaiming with a loud voice, Who is worthy to open the book, and to loose the seals thereof?</i> | A mighty angel proclaimed with a loud voice, "Who is worthy to open the scroll and break its seals?" |
| 3 <i>And no man in heaven, nor in earth, neither under the earth, was able to open the book, neither to look thereon.</i> | No one in heaven or on earth or under the earth was able to open the scroll or look into it. |
| 4 <i>And I wept much, because no man was found worthy to open and to read the book, neither to look thereon.</i> | I wept greatly because no one was found worthy to open the scroll or look into it. |
| 5 <i>And one of the elders saith unto me, Weep not: behold, the Lion of the tribe of Juda, the Root of David, hath prevailed to open the book, and to loose the seven seals thereof.</i> | Then one of the elders said to me, "Do not weep. The Lion of the tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has prevailed to open the scroll and its seven seals." |

- 6 *And I beheld, and, lo, in the midst of the throne and of the four beasts, and in the midst of the elders, stood a Lamb as it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God sent forth into all the earth.* Then I saw, in the midst of the throne and the four living creatures and among the elders, a Lamb standing — it looked as though it had been slain. It had seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God sent out into all the earth.
- 7 *And he came and took the book out of the right hand of him that sat upon the throne.* He came and took the scroll from the right hand of Him who sat on the throne.
- 8 *And when he had taken the book, the four beasts and four and twenty elders fell down before the Lamb, having every one of them harps, and golden vials full of odours, which are the prayers of saints.* When He took the scroll, the four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell down before the Lamb. Each one had a harp and golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the saints.
- 9 *And they sung a new song, saying, Thou art worthy to take the book, and to open the seals thereof: for thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by thy blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation;* And they sang a new song, saying, "You are worthy to take the book and to open the seals thereof; for You were slain, and have redeemed us to God by Your blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation,
- 10 *And hast made us unto our God kings and priests: and we shall reign on the earth.* and have made us to our God kings and priests, and we shall reign on the earth."
- 11 *And I beheld, and I heard the voice of many angels round about the throne and the beasts and the elders: and the number of them was ten thousand times ten thousand, and thousands of thousands;* I looked, and I heard the voices of many angels surrounding the throne, the living creatures, and the elders. Their number was ten thousand times ten thousand — thousands upon thousands.

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| <p>12 <i>Saying with a loud voice, Worthy is the Lamb that was slain to receive power, and riches, and wisdom, and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And every creature which is in heaven, and on the earth, and under the earth, and such as are in the sea, and all that are in them, heard I saying, Blessing, and honour, and glory, and power, be unto him that sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb for ever and ever.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And the four beasts said, Amen. And the four and twenty elders fell down and worshipped him that liveth for ever and ever.</i></p> | <p>They cried out with a loud voice: "Worthy is the Lamb Who was slain to receive power and riches and wisdom and strength and honor and glory and blessing!"</p> <p>Then I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea — all that is in them — saying: "Blessing and honor and glory and power be to Him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb for ever and ever!"</p> <p>The four living creatures said, "Amen." The twenty-four elders fell down and worshipped Him who lives for ever and ever.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Judah (*JOO-dah*) — Jacob's fourth son by Leah — ancestor of the royal tribe from which David and ultimately Jesus descended; his name means 'praise.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Ezek 2:9-10; Isa 29:11; Rev 5:7; Dan 12:4-9; Rev 6:1
- v2 — Isa 29:11-12; Rev 5:5
- v5 — Isa 11:1; Jer 23:5-6; Rev 22:16; Rom 15:12; Rom 1:3
- v6 — Zech 4:10; John 1:29; Zech 3:9; Rev 5:12; Rev 13:8
- v7 — Rev 5:1; Rev 4:2-3
- v8 — Ps 141:2; Rev 8:3-4; Phil 2:9-11; Rev 4:10; Rev 5:14
- v9 — 1 Pet 1:18-19; 1 John 1:7; Matt 26:28; Rom 3:24-26; Ps 40:3
- v10 — Rev 1:6; Dan 7:27; Rev 20:6; Dan 7:18; Rev 22:5
- v11 — Dan 7:10; Heb 12:22; Rev 4:6; Ps 148:2; Rev 4:4
- v12 — Rev 5:9; Rev 19:1; Rev 4:11; John 17:2; Rev 7:12
- v13 — Phil 2:10; 1 Chr 29:11; Ps 148:2-13; Rev 5:12; Rom 11:36
- v14 — Rev 19:4; Rev 4:9-11; Rev 5:8

Chapter 6

The Lamb opens six seals. The first four bring the four horsemen — conquest, war, famine, and death. The fifth seal reveals the souls of martyrs under the altar crying, "How long, O Lord?" The sixth seal brings a great earthquake, the sun turns black, the moon becomes as blood, and the kings of the earth hide themselves, crying to the mountains to fall on them.

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| 1 | <i>And I saw when the Lamb opened one of the seals, and I heard, as it were the noise of thunder, one of the four beasts saying, Come and see.</i> | I watched as the Lamb opened the first of the seven seals. I heard one of the four living creatures say with a voice like thunder, "Come." |
| 2 | <i>And I saw, and behold a white horse: and he that sat on him had a bow; and a crown was given unto him: and he went forth conquering, and to conquer.</i> | I looked, and there before me was a white horse. Its rider held a bow. A crown was given to him, and he rode out as a conqueror bent on conquest. |
| 3 | <i>And when he had opened the second seal, I heard the second beast say, Come and see.</i> | When the Lamb opened the second seal, I heard the second living creature say, "Come." |
| 4 | <i>And there went out another horse that was red: and power was given to him that sat thereon to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another: and there was given unto him a great sword.</i> | Another horse came out — a fiery red one. Its rider was given power to take peace from the earth and to make men kill one another. A great sword was given to him. |
| 5 | <i>And when he had opened the third seal, I heard the third beast say, Come and see. And I beheld, and lo a black horse; and he that sat on him had a pair of balances in his hand.</i> | When the Lamb opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature say, "Come." I looked, and there before me was a black horse. Its rider was holding a pair of scales in His hand. |
| 6 | <i>And I heard a voice in the midst of the four beasts say, A measure of wheat for a penny, and three measures of barley for a penny; and see thou hurt not the oil and the wine.</i> | Then I heard what sounded like a voice among the four living creatures, saying, "A quart of wheat for a day's wages, and three quarts of barley for a day's wages. Do not damage the oil and the wine." |

- 7 *And when he had opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth beast say, Come and see.* When the Lamb opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth living creature say, "Come."
- 8 *And I looked, and behold a pale horse: and his name that sat on him was Death, and Hell followed with him. And power was given unto them over the fourth part of the earth, to kill with sword, and with hunger, and with death, and with the beasts of the earth.* I looked, and there before me was a pale horse. Its rider's name was Death, and Hell followed close behind him. They were given power over a fourth of the earth — to kill by sword, famine, plague, and by the wild beasts of the earth.
- 9 *And when he had opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of them that were slain for the word of God, and for the testimony which they held:* When he opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of those who had been slain for the word of God and for the testimony they had maintained.
- 10 *And they cried with a loud voice, saying, How long, O Lord, holy and true, dost thou not judge and avenge our blood on them that dwell on the earth?* They cried out with a loud voice, "How long, O Lord — holy and true — will You wait before You judge and avenge our blood on those who live on the earth?"
- 11 *And white robes were given unto every one of them; and it was said unto them, that they should rest yet for a little season, until their fellowservants also and their brethren, that should be killed as they were, should be fulfilled.* Each of them was given a white robe. They were told to wait a little longer, until the full number of their fellow servants and brothers who were to be killed as they had been killed was completed.
- 12 *And I beheld when he had opened the sixth seal, and, lo, there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth of hair, and the moon became as blood;* I watched as he opened the sixth seal. There was a great earthquake. The sun turned black like sackcloth made of goat hair. The whole moon turned blood red.

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| 13 | <i>And the stars of heaven fell unto the earth, even as a fig tree casteth her untimely figs, when she is shaken of a mighty wind.</i> | The stars of the sky fell to earth, like figs dropping from a fig tree when shaken by a strong wind. |
| 14 | <i>And the heaven departed as a scroll when it is rolled together; and every mountain and island were moved out of their places.</i> | The sky receded like a scroll rolling up, and every mountain and island was moved from its place. |
| 15 | <i>And the kings of the earth, and the great men, and the rich men, and the chief captains, and the mighty men, and every bondman, and every free man, hid themselves in the dens and in the rocks of the mountains;</i> | The kings of the earth, the great men, the rich, the military commanders, the mighty, and every slave and free man hid themselves in the caves and among the rocks of the mountains. |
| 16 | <i>And said to the mountains and rocks, Fall on us, and hide us from the face of him that sitteth on the throne, and from the wrath of the Lamb:</i> | They called to the mountains and rocks, "Fall on us and hide us from the face of Him who sits on the throne and from the wrath of the Lamb!" |
| 17 | <i>For the great day of his wrath is come; and who shall be able to stand?</i> | "The great day of His wrath has come, and who is able to stand?" |

Words in this chapter:

seal (*SEEL*) — a mark of authority that secures a scroll; the Lamb opens the seven seals, each releasing a judgment on the earth

wrath (*RAWTH*) — God's holy anger against sin; the great day of His wrath has come

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 5:1; Rev 6:5; Rev 6:7; Rev 4:5-7; Rev 5:5-7
v4 — Zech 6:2; Matt 10:34; Rev 13:10; Rev 17:6
v8 — Hos 13:14; Jer 15:2-3; Rev 1:18; Zech 6:3; Ezek 14:13-21
v9 — Rev 20:4; John 16:2; Rev 1:9; Rev 12:11-17; Rev 2:13
v10 — Rev 19:2; Rev 11:18; Ps 9:12; Rom 12:19; 2 Thess 1:6-8
v11 — Rev 14:13; Rev 7:9; Rev 3:4-5; Rev 7:14; Heb 11:40
v12 — Matt 24:29; Joel 2:10; Acts 2:19-20; Mark 13:24-25; Joel 3:15
v13 — Isa 34:4; Matt 24:29; Rev 9:1; Rev 8:10-12
v14 — Isa 34:4; Rev 16:20; 2 Pet 3:10; Heb 1:11-13; Ps 102:26
v15 — Isa 2:19; Isa 2:21; Isa 24:21-22; Isa 2:10

v16 — Luke 23:30; Hos 10:8; Rev 4:2; Rev 20:11

v17 — Joel 2:11; Mal 3:2; Ps 76:7; Joel 2:31; Jer 30:7

Chapter 7

John sees four angels holding back the winds of the earth until one hundred forty-four thousand from the twelve tribes of Israel are sealed on their foreheads. He then sees a great multitude that no man can number, out of every nation and tongue, standing before the throne in white robes, who have come out of great tribulation and washed their robes in the blood of the Lamb.

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| <p>1 <i>And after these things I saw four angels standing on the four corners of the earth, holding the four winds of the earth, that the wind should not blow on the earth, nor on the sea, nor on any tree.</i></p> | <p>After this I saw four angels standing at the four corners of the earth, holding back the four winds of the earth so no wind would blow on the land, the sea, or any tree.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And I saw another angel ascending from the east, having the seal of the living God: and he cried with a loud voice to the four angels, to whom it was given to hurt the earth and the sea,</i></p> | <p>Then I saw another angel coming up from the east, holding the seal of the living God. He called out with a loud voice to the four angels who had been given power to harm the land and the sea:</p> |
| <p>3 <i>Saying, Hurt not the earth, neither the sea, nor the trees, till we have sealed the servants of our God in their foreheads.</i></p> | <p>"Do not harm the land or the sea or the trees until we have sealed the servants of our God on their foreheads."</p> |
| <p>4 <i>And I heard the number of them which were sealed: and there were sealed an hundred and forty and four thousand of all the tribes of the children of Israel.</i></p> | <p>Then I heard the number of those who were sealed: 144,000 from all the tribes of the children of Israel.</p> |
| <p>5 <i>Of the tribe of Juda were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Reuben were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Gad were sealed twelve thousand.</i></p> | <p>From the tribe of Judah 12,000 were sealed. From the tribe of Reuben 12,000. From the tribe of Gad 12,000.</p> |

- 6 *Of the tribe of Aser were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Nephtalim were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Manasses were sealed twelve thousand.* From the tribe of Aser 12,000. From the tribe of Nephtalim 12,000. From the tribe of Manasses 12,000.
- 7 *Of the tribe of Simeon were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Levi were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Issachar were sealed twelve thousand.* From the tribe of Simeon 12,000. From the tribe of Levi 12,000. From the tribe of Issachar 12,000.
- 8 *Of the tribe of Zabulon were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Joseph were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Benjamin were sealed twelve thousand.* From the tribe of Zabulon 12,000. From the tribe of Joseph 12,000. From the tribe of Benjamin 12,000.
- 9 *After this I beheld, and, lo, a great multitude, which no man could number, of all nations, and kindreds, and people, and tongues, stood before the throne, and before the Lamb, clothed with white robes, and palms in their hands;* After this I looked, and there was a great crowd that no one could count — from every nation, every family, every people and language. They stood before the throne and before the Lamb, wearing white robes and holding palm branches in their hands.
- 10 *And cried with a loud voice, saying, Salvation to our God which sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb.* They cried out with a loud voice, "Salvation belongs to our God Who sits on the throne, and to the Lamb!"
- 11 *And all the angels stood round about the throne, and about the elders and the four beasts, and fell before the throne on their faces, and worshipped God,* All the angels were standing around the throne and around the elders and the four living creatures. They fell on their faces before the throne and worshipped God,
- 12 *Saying, Amen: Blessing, and glory, and wisdom, and thanksgiving, and honour, and power, and might, be unto our God for ever and ever. Amen.* Saying, "Amen! Blessing and glory and wisdom and thanksgiving and honor and power and might be to our God for ever and ever. Amen."

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| <p>13 <i>And one of the elders answered, saying unto me, What are these which are arrayed in white robes? and whence came they?</i></p> <p>14 <i>And I said unto him, Sir, thou knowest. And he said to me, These are they which came out of great tribulation, and have washed their robes, and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.</i></p> <p>15 <i>Therefore are they before the throne of God, and serve him day and night in his temple: and he that sitteth on the throne shall dwell among them.</i></p> <p>16 <i>They shall hunger no more, neither thirst any more; neither shall the sun light on them, nor any heat.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For the Lamb which is in the midst of the throne shall feed them, and shall lead them unto living fountains of waters: and God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes.</i></p> | <p>Then one of the elders asked me, "Who are these dressed in white robes, and from where did they come?"</p> <p>I answered, "Sir, you know." He said to me, "These are the ones who have come out of the great tribulation. They have washed their robes and made them white in the blood of the Lamb."</p> <p>"Therefore they are before the throne of God and serve Him day and night in His temple. He who sits on the throne will shelter them."</p> <p>"They will never be hungry or thirsty again. The sun will not beat on them, nor any scorching heat."</p> <p>"The Lamb in the center before the throne will be their Shepherd. He will lead them to springs of living water. And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Benjamin (*BEN-jah-min*) — Jacob's twelfth and youngest son, Rachel's second — his tribe settled around Jerusalem; his name means 'son of my right hand.'

Gad (*GAD*) — Jacob's seventh son, by Zilpah (Leah's handmaid) — his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'good fortune.'

Issachar (*IS-ah-kar*) — Jacob's ninth son by Leah — his tribe settled in the central valley of Canaan; his name means 'he is wages' or 'man of hire.'

Joseph (*JO-zef*) — Jacob's eleventh son, Rachel's firstborn — sold by his brothers into slavery in Egypt; rose to become Pharaoh's second-in-command; his name means 'may he add.'

Levi (*LEE-vy*) — Jacob's third son by Leah — ancestor of the priestly tribe that served in the tabernacle and temple; his name means 'attached' or 'joined.'

Reuben (*ROO-ben*) — Jacob's firstborn son by Leah — lost his birthright for sleeping with his father's concubine; his tribe settled east of the Jordan; his name means 'see, a son.'

Simeon (*SIM-ee-on*) — Jacob's second son by Leah — with Levi, he slaughtered the men of Shechem; his tribe was scattered in Israel; his name means 'he hears.'

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 24:31; Dan 7:2; Jer 49:36; Mark 13:27; Dan 8:8
- v2 — 2 Cor 1:22; Eph 4:30; Rev 7:3-8; Eph 1:13; 2 Tim 2:19
- v3 — Ezek 9:4; Rev 22:4; Rev 9:4; Rev 13:16; Ex 12:13
- v4 — Rev 14:1; Rev 14:3; Luke 22:30; Matt 19:28; Acts 26:7
- v9 — Rev 5:9; John 12:13; Ps 117:1-2; Rev 7:13-15; Ps 2:8
- v10 — Rev 19:1; Ps 3:8; Rev 12:10; Isa 45:21; Rev 22:3
- v11 — Rev 5:11-13; Rev 4:10; Rev 19:4-6; Rev 4:6; Ps 103:20-21
- v12 — Rev 5:12-14; Jude 1:25; Ps 100:4; Col 3:17; Rev 19:4
- v14 — 1 John 1:7; Rev 22:14; Heb 13:12; Rev 1:5; Rev 12:11
- v15 — Rev 21:3-4; Rev 22:3
- v16 — Isa 49:10; Ps 121:6; Matt 5:6; John 4:14; Luke 6:21
- v17 — John 7:37-38; Ps 36:8-9; John 4:14; Ps 23:1-2; John 4:11

Chapter 8

The Lamb opens the seventh seal, and there is silence in heaven for about half an hour. Seven angels are given seven trumpets. The first four trumpets bring hail and fire mixed with blood, a burning mountain cast into the sea, a great star called Wormwood that poisons the waters, and darkness on a third of the sun, moon, and stars.

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| 1 | <i>And when he had opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven about the space of half an hour.</i> | When the Lamb opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven for about half an hour. |
| 2 | <i>And I saw the seven angels which stood before God; and to them were given seven trumpets.</i> | I saw the seven angels who stand before God, and seven trumpets were given to them. |
| 3 | <i>And another angel came and stood at the altar, having a golden censer; and there was given unto him much incense, that he should offer it with the prayers of all saints upon the golden altar which was before the throne.</i> | Another angel came and stood at the altar, holding a golden censer. He was given a great quantity of incense to offer with the prayers of all the saints on the golden altar before the throne. |

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| 4 | <i>And the smoke of the incense, which came with the prayers of the saints, ascended up before God out of the angel's hand.</i> | The smoke of the incense, together with the prayers of the saints, rose up before God from the angel's hand. |
| 5 | <i>And the angel took the censer, and filled it with fire of the altar, and cast it into the earth: and there were voices, and thunderings, and lightnings, and an earthquake.</i> | Then the angel took the censer, filled it with fire from the altar, and hurled it to the earth. There came thunder, rumblings, flashes of lightning, and an earthquake. |
| 6 | <i>And the seven angels which had the seven trumpets prepared themselves to sound.</i> | Then the seven angels who had the seven trumpets prepared to sound them. |
| 7 | <i>The first angel sounded, and there followed hail and fire mingled with blood, and they were cast upon the earth: and the third part of trees was burnt up, and all green grass was burnt up.</i> | The first angel sounded his trumpet. Hail and fire mixed with blood were hurled down on the earth. A third of the earth was burned up, a third of the trees were burned up, and all green grass was burned up. |
| 8 | <i>And the second angel sounded, and as it were a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea: and the third part of the sea became blood;</i> | The second angel sounded his trumpet. Something like a huge mountain blazing with fire was thrown into the sea. A third of the sea turned to blood. |
| 9 | <i>And the third part of the creatures which were in the sea, and had life, died; and the third part of the ships were destroyed.</i> | A third of the living creatures in the sea died, and a third of the ships were destroyed. |
| 10 | <i>And the third angel sounded, and there fell a great star from heaven, burning as it were a lamp, and it fell upon the third part of the rivers, and upon the fountains of waters;</i> | The third angel sounded his trumpet. A great star blazing like a torch fell from the sky on a third of the rivers and on the springs of water. |

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| <p>11 <i>And the name of the star is called Wormwood: and the third part of the waters became wormwood; and many men died of the waters, because they were made bitter.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And the fourth angel sounded, and the third part of the sun was smitten, and the third part of the moon, and the third part of the stars; so as the third part of them was darkened, and the day shone not for a third part of it, and the night likewise.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And I beheld, and heard an angel flying through the midst of heaven, saying with a loud voice, Woe, woe, woe, to the inhabitants of the earth by reason of the other voices of the trumpet of the three angels, which are yet to sound!</i></p> | <p>The name of the star is Wormwood. A third of the waters turned bitter like wormwood, and many people died from the waters, because they had turned bitter.</p> <p>The fourth angel sounded his trumpet. A third of the sun was struck, a third of the moon, and a third of the stars — so that a third of them turned dark. A third of the day had no light, and a third of the night as well.</p> <p>I looked, and I heard an eagle flying in midair call out with a loud voice: "Woe! Woe! Woe to the people who live on the earth, because of the trumpet blasts about to be sounded by the other three angels!"</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Zech 2:13; Hab 2:20; Rev 6:1; Ps 62:1; Job 4:16
- v2 — Luke 1:19; Rev 11:15; Amos 3:6-8; Rev 8:6-9:1; Matt 18:10
- v3 — Rev 5:8; Ps 141:2; Rev 8:4; Luke 1:10; Mal 1:11
- v4 — Ps 141:2; Luke 1:10
- v5 — Rev 11:19; Rev 4:5; Isa 29:6; Acts 16:26
- v6 — Rev 8:2
- v7 — Ezek 38:22; Rev 9:4; Rev 9:18; Rev 9:15; Isa 28:2
- v8 — Jer 51:25; Ex 7:17-21; Mark 11:23
- v10 — Rev 16:4; Isa 14:12; Rev 9:1; Rev 6:13
- v11 — Jer 23:15; Jer 9:15; Deut 29:18; Prov 5:4
- v12 — Joel 2:31; Isa 13:10; Joel 2:10; Rev 8:7-12; Matt 24:29
- v13 — Rev 9:12; Rev 11:14; Ezek 2:10; Rev 14:6; Heb 1:14

Chapter 9

The fifth trumpet opens the bottomless pit, and locusts with the power of scorpions torment men for five months — their king is the angel of the bottomless pit called Abaddon. The sixth trumpet releases four angels bound at the great river Euphrates, and an army of two hundred thousand thousand horsemen kills a third part of men, yet the rest do not repent of their idolatry or murders.

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| 1 | <i>And the fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star fall from heaven unto the earth: and to him was given the key of the bottomless pit.</i> | The fifth angel sounded his trumpet. I saw a star that had fallen from the sky to the earth. The star was given the key to the shaft of the bottomless pit. |
| 2 | <i>And he opened the bottomless pit; and there arose a smoke out of the pit, as the smoke of a great furnace; and the sun and the air were darkened by reason of the smoke of the pit.</i> | When he opened the bottomless pit, smoke rose from it like smoke from a gigantic furnace. The sun and sky were darkened by the smoke from the pit. |
| 3 | <i>And there came out of the smoke locusts upon the earth: and unto them was given power, as the scorpions of the earth have power.</i> | Out of the smoke came locusts down on the earth. They were given power like the power of scorpions of the earth. |
| 4 | <i>And it was commanded them that they should not hurt the grass of the earth, neither any green thing, neither any tree; but only those men which have not the seal of God in their foreheads.</i> | They were told not to harm the grass of the earth or any plant or tree, but only those people who did not have the seal of God on their foreheads. |
| 5 | <i>And to them it was given that they should not kill them, but that they should be tormented five months: and their torment was as the torment of a scorpion, when he striketh a man.</i> | They were not given power to kill them, but only to torment them for five months. Their torment was like the sting of a scorpion when it strikes a person. |
| 6 | <i>And in those days shall men seek death, and shall not find it; and shall desire to die, and death shall flee from them.</i> | During those days people will seek death but will not find it. They will long to die, but death will flee from them. |

- 7 *And the shapes of the locusts were like unto horses prepared unto battle; and on their heads were as it were crowns like gold, and their faces were as the faces of men.* The locusts looked like horses prepared for battle. On their heads they wore what looked like golden crowns. Their faces were like human faces.
- 8 *And they had hair as the hair of women, and their teeth were as the teeth of lions.* Their hair was like women's hair, and their teeth were like lions' teeth.
- 9 *And they had breastplates, as it were breastplates of iron; and the sound of their wings was as the sound of chariots of many horses running to battle.* They had chests like breastplates of iron, and the sound of their wings was like the thundering of many horses and chariots rushing into battle.
- 10 *And they had tails like unto scorpions, and there were stings in their tails: and their power was to hurt men five months.* They had tails with stingers like scorpions, and in their tails they had power to torment people for five months.
- 11 *And they had a king over them, which is the angel of the bottomless pit, whose name in the Hebrew tongue is Abaddon, but in the Greek tongue hath his name Apollyon.* They had as king over them the angel of the bottomless pit. His name in Hebrew is Abaddon, and in Greek his name is Apollyon.
- 12 *One woe is past; and, behold, there come two woes more hereafter.* The first woe is past. Two other woes are still to come.
- 13 *And the sixth angel sounded, and I heard a voice from the four horns of the golden altar which is before God,* The sixth angel sounded his trumpet. I heard a voice coming from the four horns of the golden altar before God.
- 14 *Saying to the sixth angel which had the trumpet, Loose the four angels which are bound in the great river Euphrates.* It said to the sixth angel who had the trumpet, "Release the four angels who are bound at the great river Euphrates."

- 15 *And the four angels were loosed, which were prepared for an hour, and a day, and a month, and a year, for to slay the third part of men.* The four angels who had been kept ready for this very hour, day, month, and year were released to kill a third of mankind.
- 16 *And the number of the army of the horsemen were two hundred thousand thousand: and I heard the number of them.* The number of the mounted troops was two hundred million. I heard their number.
- 17 *And thus I saw the horses in the vision, and them that sat on them, having breastplates of fire, and of jacinth, and brimstone: and the heads of the horses were as the heads of lions; and out of their mouths issued fire and smoke and brimstone.* In my vision the horses and their riders wore breastplates of fiery red, dark blue, and yellow like sulfur. The heads of the horses were like the heads of lions. Out of their mouths came fire, smoke, and sulfur.
- 18 *By these three was the third part of men killed, by the fire, and by the smoke, and by the brimstone, which issued out of their mouths.* A third of mankind was killed by the three plagues — the fire, the smoke, and the sulfur that came out of their mouths.
- 19 *For their power is in their mouth, and in their tails: for their tails were like unto serpents, and had heads, and with them they do hurt.* The horses' power to harm was in their mouths and in their tails. Their tails were like snakes, with heads that could inflict injury.
- 20 *And the rest of the men which were not killed by these plagues yet repented not of the works of their hands, that they should not worship devils, and idols of gold, and silver, and brass, and stone, and of wood: which neither can see, nor hear, nor walk:* The rest of mankind — those not killed by these plagues — still did not repent of the works of their hands. They did not stop worshipping demons and idols of gold, silver, bronze, stone, and wood — which cannot see, hear, or walk.
- 21 *Neither repented they of their murders, nor of their sorceries, nor of their fornication, nor of their thefts.* They did not repent of their murders, their sorceries, their fornication, or their thefts.

Words in this chapter:

Euphrates (*yoo-FRAY-teez*) — One of the four rivers of Eden — the great river of Mesopotamia; the eastern boundary of the land promised to Abraham; runs through modern Iraq.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 8:10; Rev 9:2; Rom 10:7; Rev 1:18; 2 Tim 3:1-5
- v2 — Joel 2:10; Gen 19:28; Joel 2:2; Joel 2:30; Isa 14:31
- v4 — Ezek 9:4; Rev 7:2-4; Rev 14:1; Ex 12:23; Ezek 9:6
- v5 — Rev 9:10; Job 2:6; Rev 9:3
- v6 — Luke 23:30; Jer 8:3; Rev 6:16; Isa 2:19; Hos 10:8
- v10 — Rev 9:5; Rev 9:3
- v14 — Rev 16:12; 2 Sam 8:3; Gen 2:14; Rev 9:15; Jer 51:63
- v15 — Rev 9:18; Rev 8:7
- v17 — Rev 9:18; Rev 21:8; 1 Chr 12:8; Rev 14:10
- v18 — Rev 9:17; Rev 9:15
- v20 — Dan 5:23; Deut 31:29; 1 Tim 4:1; Rom 1:21-23; Jer 1:16
- v21 — Rev 21:8; Rev 22:15; 2 Cor 12:21; Rev 17:5; Rev 17:2

Chapter 10

John sees a mighty angel come down from heaven with a little book open in his hand, setting his right foot on the sea and his left on the earth. The angel swears by Him who lives for ever that there shall be time no longer, and when the seventh angel sounds, the mystery of God shall be finished. John eats the little book, which is sweet in his mouth but bitter in his belly.

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| <p>1 <i>And I saw another mighty angel come down from heaven, clothed with a cloud: and a rainbow was upon his head, and his face was as it were the sun, and his feet as pillars of fire:</i></p> | <p>Then I saw another mighty angel coming down from heaven, wrapped in a cloud. A rainbow was on his head. His face was like the sun, and his legs were like pillars of fire.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And he had in his hand a little book open: and he set his right foot upon the sea, and his left foot on the earth,</i></p> | <p>He was holding in his hand a little scroll, open. He placed his right foot on the sea and his left foot on the land.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And cried with a loud voice, as when a lion roareth: and when he had cried, seven thunders uttered their voices.</i></p> | <p>He called out with a loud voice, like a lion roaring. When he called out, the seven thunders sounded with their voices.</p> |

- 4 *And when the seven thunders had uttered their voices, I was about to write: and I heard a voice from heaven saying unto me, Seal up those things which the seven thunders uttered, and write them not.* When the seven thunders spoke, I was about to write. But I heard a voice from heaven say, "Seal up what the seven thunders said, and do not write it down."
- 5 *And the angel which I saw stand upon the sea and upon the earth lifted up his hand to heaven,* Then the angel I had seen standing on the sea and on the land raised his right hand to heaven.
- 6 *And sware by him that liveth for ever and ever, who created heaven, and the things that therein are, and the earth, and the things that therein are, and the sea, and the things which are therein, that there should be time no longer:* He swore by Him who lives for ever and ever — who created heaven and all that is in it, the earth and all that is in it, and the sea and all that is in it — and said, "There will be no more delay."
- 7 *But in the days of the voice of the seventh angel, when he shall begin to sound, the mystery of God should be finished, as he hath declared to his servants the prophets.* "In the days when the seventh angel is about to sound his trumpet, the mystery of God will be accomplished, just as He announced to His servants the prophets."
- 8 *And the voice which I heard from heaven spake unto me again, and said, Go and take the little book which is open in the hand of the angel which standeth upon the sea and upon the earth.* Then the voice I had heard from heaven spoke to me again: "Go, take the little scroll that is open in the hand of the angel who is standing on the sea and on the land."
- 9 *And I went unto the angel, and said unto him, Give me the little book. And he said unto me, Take it, and eat it up; and it shall make thy belly bitter, but it shall be in thy mouth sweet as honey.* So I went to the angel and asked him to give me the little scroll. He said to me, "Take it and eat it. It will make your stomach sour, but in your mouth it will be sweet as honey."

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| <p>10 <i>And I took the little book out of the angel's hand, and ate it up; and it was in my mouth sweet as honey: and as soon as I had eaten it, my belly was bitter.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And he said unto me, Thou must prophesy again before many peoples, and nations, and tongues, and kings.</i></p> | <p>I took the little scroll from the angel's hand and ate it. It was sweet as honey in my mouth, but when I had eaten it, my stomach turned sour.</p> <p>Then I was told, "You must prophesy again about many peoples, nations, languages, and kings."</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

little book — a small scroll given to John by a mighty angel; sweet in the mouth but bitter in the belly, symbolizing the mixed nature of prophecy

mystery (*MIS-tur-ee*) — a truth hidden in God's plan, now revealed; the mystery of God shall be finished

Cross-References:

- v1 — Matt 17:2; Ezek 1:28; Rev 1:15-16; Rev 5:2; Dan 10:6
- v2 — Rev 10:5; Ezek 2:9-10; Rev 10:8-10; Rev 5:1-5
- v4 — Dan 12:4; Dan 8:26; Dan 12:9
- v5 — Dan 12:7; Deut 32:40
- v6 — Rev 4:11
- v7 — Eph 3:3-9; Rom 16:25; Luke 24:44-47; Amos 3:7; Acts 3:21
- v9 — Ezek 3:1-3; Jer 15:16; Ezek 2:8; Job 23:12; Ezek 3:14
- v10 — Ezek 3:3; Prov 16:24; Ps 119:103; Ps 19:10
- v11 — Ezek 37:4; Jer 1:9-10

Chapter 11

John is told to measure the temple of God, and two witnesses prophesy for one thousand two hundred and sixty days. The beast from the bottomless pit kills the witnesses, but after three and a half days the Spirit of life from God enters them and they ascend to heaven. The seventh trumpet sounds, and great voices in heaven declare, "The kingdoms of this world are become the kingdoms of our Lord, and of His Christ."

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| <p>1 <i>And there was given me a reed like unto a rod: and the angel stood, saying, Rise, and measure the temple of God, and the altar, and them that worship therein.</i></p> | <p>I was given a reed like a measuring rod. The angel stood and said, "Rise and measure the temple of God and the altar, and count those who worship there."</p> |
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- 2 *But the court which is without the temple leave out, and measure it not; for it is given unto the Gentiles: and the holy city shall they tread under foot forty and two months.* "But do not measure the outer court — leave it out. It has been given to the Gentiles. They will trample the holy city for forty-two months."
- 3 *And I will give power unto my two witnesses, and they shall prophesy a thousand two hundred and threescore days, clothed in sackcloth.* "I will give power to My two witnesses, and they will prophesy for 1,260 days, clothed in sackcloth."
- 4 *These are the two olive trees, and the two candlesticks standing before the God of the earth.* These are the two olive trees and the two lampstands that stand before the Lord of the earth.
- 5 *And if any man will hurt them, fire proceedeth out of their mouth, and devoureth their enemies: and if any man will hurt them, he must in this manner be killed.* If anyone tries to harm them, fire comes from their mouths and devours their enemies. Anyone who wants to harm them must be killed in this way.
- 6 *These have power to shut heaven, that it rain not in the days of their prophecy: and have power over waters to turn them to blood, and to smite the earth with all plagues, as often as they will.* They have power to shut up the sky so that no rain will fall during the time they are prophesying. They have power to turn the waters to blood and to strike the earth with every kind of plague as often as they choose.
- 7 *And when they shall have finished their testimony, the beast that ascendeth out of the bottomless pit shall make war against them, and shall overcome them, and kill them.* When they have finished their testimony, the beast that comes up from the bottomless pit will make war against them and overcome them and kill them.
- 8 *And their dead bodies shall lie in the street of the great city, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, where also our Lord was crucified.* Their bodies will lie in the street of the great city — which is spiritually called Sodom and Egypt — where also their Lord was crucified.

- 9 *And they of the people and kindreds and tongues and nations shall see their dead bodies three days and an half, and shall not suffer their dead bodies to be put in graves.* For three and a half days, people from every nation, family, language, and people will stare at their bodies and refuse to allow them to be buried.
- 10 *And they that dwell upon the earth shall rejoice over them, and make merry, and shall send gifts one to another; because these two prophets tormented them that dwelt on the earth.* The people of the earth will celebrate and be glad. They will send each other gifts, because these two prophets had tormented those who live on the earth.
- 11 *And after three days and an half the Spirit of life from God entered into them, and they stood upon their feet; and great fear fell upon them which saw them.* But after three and a half days, the breath of life from God entered them. They stood on their feet, and great terror struck those who saw them.
- 12 *And they heard a great voice from heaven saying unto them, Come up hither. And they ascended up to heaven in a cloud; and their enemies beheld them.* Then they heard a loud voice from heaven calling to them, "Come up here." They went up to heaven in a cloud, while their enemies watched.
- 13 *And the same hour was there a great earthquake, and the tenth part of the city fell, and in the earthquake were slain of men seven thousand: and the remnant were affrighted, and gave glory to the God of heaven.* At that same hour there was a great earthquake. A tenth of the city collapsed. Seven thousand people were killed in the earthquake, and the survivors were terrified and gave glory to the God of heaven.
- 14 *The second woe is past; and, behold, the third woe cometh quickly.* The second woe has passed. The third woe is coming soon.
- 15 *And the seventh angel sounded; and there were great voices in heaven, saying, The kingdoms of this world are become the kingdoms of our Lord, and of his Christ; and he shall reign for ever and ever.* The seventh angel sounded His trumpet. Great voices in heaven said, "The kingdoms of this world have become the kingdoms of our Lord and of His Christ, and He will reign for ever and ever."

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| <p>16 <i>And the four and twenty elders, which sat before God on their seats, fell upon their faces, and worshipped God,</i></p> <p>17 <i>Saying, We give thee thanks, O Lord God Almighty, which art, and wast, and art to come; because thou hast taken to thee thy great power, and hast reigned.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the nations were angry, and thy wrath is come, and the time of the dead, that they should be judged, and that thou shouldest give reward unto thy servants the prophets, and to the saints, and them that fear thy name, small and great; and shouldest destroy them which destroy the earth.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the temple of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen in his temple the ark of his testament: and there were lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an earthquake, and great hail.</i></p> | <p>The twenty-four elders who were seated on their thrones before God fell on their faces and worshipped God,</p> <p>Saying, "We give You thanks, O Lord God Almighty, who is and who was, because You have taken Your great power and have begun to reign."</p> <p>"The nations were angry, and your wrath has come. The time has come to judge the dead and to reward Your servants the prophets and the saints — those who fear Your name, both small and great — and to destroy those who destroy the earth."</p> <p>Then the temple of God in heaven was opened, and within His temple was seen the ark of His covenant. There came flashes of lightning, rumblings, thunder, an earthquake, and a great hailstorm.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Gentiles (*JEN-tylz*) — All non-Jewish peoples — in the OT, the nations outside Israel; in the NT, the Gentile mission is a major theme as the gospel goes to the whole world.

Sodom (*SOD-um*) — A city destroyed by fire and brimstone from God because of its great wickedness — Lot and his family were rescued before its destruction; became a symbol of divine judgment.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rev 21:15; Ezek 42:15-20; Zech 2:1-2

v2 — Luke 21:24; Dan 7:25; Rev 12:6; Rev 11:3; Dan 12:7

v3 — Rev 12:6; Rev 11:2; Deut 19:15; Rev 13:5; Isa 22:12

v4 — Zech 4:11-14; Zech 4:2-3; Jer 11:16; Ps 52:8; Isa 54:5

v5 — Jer 5:14; 2 Kgs 1:10-12; Hos 6:5; Isa 11:4; Num 16:28-35

v7 — Rev 13:7; Dan 8:23-24; Dan 7:25
v8 — Jer 23:14; Rev 18:10; Heb 13:12; Ezek 16:53-55; Rev 18:21
v11 — Gen 2:7; Rom 8:11; Rom 8:2; Ezek 37:5-14; Acts 5:5
v15 — Dan 7:14; Rev 12:10; Dan 7:27; Rev 10:7; Zech 14:9
v17 — Rev 1:8; Rev 16:5; Rev 19:6; Rev 4:8-9; Rev 1:4
v18 — Rev 19:5; Rev 20:12; Rev 6:10-11; Rev 13:10; Rev 22:12
v19 — Rev 16:21; Rev 15:5-8; Ezek 38:22; Rev 4:5; Rev 8:5

Chapter 12

John sees a woman clothed with the sun who brings forth a man child destined to rule all nations with a rod of iron, and the child is caught up to God and His throne. A great red dragon — that old serpent called the Devil and Satan — is cast out of heaven, and Michael and his angels war against him. The dragon persecutes the woman, who is given wings to fly into the wilderness for a time, times, and half a time.

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| 1 | <i>And there appeared a great wonder in heaven; a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars:</i> | A great sign appeared in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, with the moon under her feet and a crown of twelve stars on her head. |
| 2 | <i>And she being with child cried, travailing in birth, and pained to be delivered.</i> | She was pregnant and cried out in the pain of labor, about to give birth. |
| 3 | <i>And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.</i> | Then another sign appeared in heaven: a great red dragon with seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns on his heads. |
| 4 | <i>And his tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth: and the dragon stood before the woman which was ready to be delivered, for to devour her child as soon as it was born.</i> | His tail swept a third of the stars from the sky and hurled them to the earth. The dragon stood in front of the woman who was about to give birth, so that he might devour her child the moment it was born. |
| 5 | <i>And she brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: and her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.</i> | She gave birth to a son, a male child, who will rule all the nations with an iron scepter. Her child was caught up to God and to His throne. |

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| 6 | <i>And the woman fled into the wilderness, where she hath a place prepared of God, that they should feed her there a thousand two hundred and threescore days.</i> | The woman fled into the wilderness to a place prepared for her by God, where she would be cared for for 1,260 days. |
| 7 | <i>And there was war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon; and the dragon fought and his angels,</i> | Then war broke out in heaven. Michael and his angels fought against the dragon, and the dragon and his angels fought back. |
| 8 | <i>And prevailed not; neither was their place found any more in heaven.</i> | But the dragon was not strong enough, and they lost their place in heaven. |
| 9 | <i>And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world: he was cast out into the earth, and his angels were cast out with him.</i> | The great dragon was hurled down — that ancient serpent called the Devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray. He was hurled to the earth, and his angels with him. |
| 10 | <i>And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night.</i> | Then I heard a loud voice in heaven say: "Now have come the salvation and the power and the kingdom of our God, and the authority of His Christ. For the accuser of our brothers has been hurled down — He who accused them before our God day and night. |
| 11 | <i>And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death.</i> | They overcame Him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony. They did not love their lives so much as to shrink from death. |
| 12 | <i>Therefore rejoice, ye heavens, and ye that dwell in them. Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and of the sea! for the devil is come down unto you, having great wrath, because he knoweth that he hath but a short time.</i> | Therefore rejoice, you heavens and you who dwell in them! But woe to the earth and the sea, because the devil has gone down to you. He is filled with fury, because he knows that his time is short." |

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| <p>13 <i>And when the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, he persecuted the woman which brought forth the man child.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And to the woman were given two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness, into her place, where she is nourished for a time, and times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And the serpent cast out of his mouth water as a flood after the woman, that he might cause her to be carried away of the flood.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the earth helped the woman, and the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed up the flood which the dragon cast out of his mouth.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And the dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed, which keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ.</i></p> | <p>When the dragon saw that he had been hurled to the earth, he pursued the woman who had given birth to the male child.</p> <p>The woman was given the two wings of a great eagle, so that she might fly to the place prepared for her in the wilderness, where she would be taken care of for a time, times and half a time, out of the serpent's reach.</p> <p>Then from his mouth the serpent spewed water like a river, to overtake the woman and sweep her away with the torrent.</p> <p>But the earth helped the woman by opening its mouth and swallowing the river that the dragon had spewed out of his mouth.</p> <p>Then the dragon was furious with the woman and went off to wage war against the rest of her offspring — those who keep God's commandments and hold to the testimony of Jesus Christ.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Luke 21:25; Eph 5:32; Isa 62:3; Luke 21:11; Isa 60:19-20
v3 — Rev 17:12; Rev 12:9; Dan 7:24; Dan 7:20; Rev 17:16
v4 — Dan 8:9-12; Rev 12:9; John 8:44
v5 — Rev 19:15; Rev 2:26-27; Ps 2:9-10; Rev 12:2
v6 — Rev 11:2-3; Rev 13:5; Rev 12:14; Rev 12:4; 1 Kgs 17:3-6
v7 — Jude 1:9; Dan 12:1; Eph 6:12; 2 Pet 2:4; Rev 20:2
v9 — Luke 10:18; John 12:31; Rev 20:10; Isa 14:12; 1 John 5:19

v10 — Zech 3:1-2; Luke 22:31; Rev 11:15; Dan 2:44; Matt 28:18

v11 — 2 Cor 10:3-5; John 16:33; 1 John 5:5; Rom 16:20; 1 Cor 15:57

v12 — Isa 49:13; Rev 18:20; Rev 8:13; Ps 96:11-13; Rev 10:6

v14 — Ex 19:4; Isa 40:31; Rev 12:6; Dan 12:7; Dan 7:25

v17 — Rev 14:12; Gen 3:15; Rev 19:10; Rev 1:2; Rev 11:7

Chapter 13

John sees a beast rise out of the sea with seven heads and ten horns, to whom the dragon gives his power and great authority, and all the world wonders after the beast. A second beast rises out of the earth, performing great signs and causing all to receive the mark of the beast — 666 — in their right hand or forehead, without which no man can buy or sell.

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| 1 | <i>And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.</i> | I stood on the sand of the seashore. Then I saw a beast rising out of the sea. It had ten horns and seven heads, with ten crowns on its horns, and on each head a name that blasphemed God. |
| 2 | <i>And the beast which I saw was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as the feet of a bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion: and the dragon gave him his power, and his seat, and great authority.</i> | The beast I saw resembled a leopard, but had feet like those of a bear and a mouth like that of a lion. The dragon gave the beast his power and his throne and great authority. |
| 3 | <i>And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.</i> | One of the heads of the beast seemed to have had a fatal wound, but the fatal wound had been healed. The whole world was filled with wonder and followed the beast. |
| 4 | <i>And they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast, saying, Who is like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?</i> | People worshiped the dragon because he had given authority to the beast, and they also worshiped the beast and asked, "Who is like the beast? Who can wage war against it?" |

- 5 *And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies; and power was given unto him to continue forty and two months.* The beast was given a mouth to speak proud words and blasphemies, and to exercise its authority for forty-two months.
- 6 *And he opened his mouth in blasphemy against God, to blaspheme his name, and his tabernacle, and them that dwell in heaven.* It opened its mouth to blaspheme God and to slander His name and His dwelling place and those who live in heaven.
- 7 *And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.* It was given power to wage war against God's holy people and to conquer them. And it was given authority over every tribe, people, language and nation.
- 8 *And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world.* All inhabitants of the earth will worship the beast — all whose names have not been written in the book of life belonging to the Lamb Who was slain from the foundation of the world.
- 9 *If any man have an ear, let him hear.* Whoever has ears, let them hear.
- 10 *He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity: he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword. Here is the patience and the faith of the saints.* "If anyone is to go into captivity, into captivity they will go. If anyone is to be killed with the sword, with the sword they will be killed." This calls for patient endurance and faithfulness on the part of God's people.
- 11 *And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb, and he spake as a dragon.* Then I saw a second beast, coming out of the earth. It had two horns like a lamb, but it spoke like a dragon.
- 12 *And he exerciseth all the power of the first beast before him, and causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast, whose deadly wound was healed.* It exercised all the authority of the first beast on its behalf, and made the earth and its inhabitants worship the first beast, whose fatal wound had been healed.

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| 13 <i>And he doeth great wonders, so that he maketh fire come down from heaven on the earth in the sight of men,</i> | And it performed great signs, even causing fire to come down from heaven to the earth in full view of the people. |
| 14 <i>And deceiveth them that dwell on the earth by the means of those miracles which he had power to do in the sight of the beast; saying to them that dwell on the earth, that they should make an image to the beast, which had the wound by a sword, and did live.</i> | Because of the signs it was given power to perform on behalf of the first beast, it deceived the inhabitants of the earth. It ordered them to set up an image in honor of the beast who was wounded by the sword and yet lived. |
| 15 <i>And he had power to give life unto the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both speak, and cause that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed.</i> | The second beast was given power to give breath to the image of the first beast, so that the image could speak and cause all who refused to worship the image to be killed. |
| 16 <i>And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads:</i> | It also forced all people, great and small, rich and poor, free and slave, to receive a mark on their right hands or on their foreheads, |
| 17 <i>And that no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name.</i> | so that they could not buy or sell unless they had the mark, which is the name of the beast or the number of its name. |
| 18 <i>Here is wisdom. Let him that hath understanding count the number of the beast: for it is the number of a man; and his number is Six hundred threescore and six.</i> | This calls for wisdom. Let the person who has insight calculate the number of the beast, for it is the number of a man. That number is 666. |

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

v1 — Rev 12:3; Rev 17:3; Dan 7:23-25; Rev 11:7; Dan 7:7-8
v2 — Dan 7:4-7; Rev 17:12; 1 Pet 5:8; Rev 20:2; Rev 12:9
v5 — Dan 7:8; Dan 7:25; Dan 11:36; Rev 12:6; Dan 7:11
v7 — Dan 7:21; Rev 11:7; Dan 7:25; Rev 12:17; Dan 8:24-25
v8 — 1 Pet 1:19-20; Eph 1:4; Matt 25:34; Rev 17:8; Rev 3:5
v10 — Jer 15:2; Isa 33:1; Rev 14:12; Rev 3:10; Luke 21:19
v11 — Dan 7:8; 2 Cor 11:13-15; Matt 7:15
v13 — Matt 24:24; Rev 19:20; 2 Thess 2:9-10; Rev 16:14; 1 Kgs 18:38
v14 — Rev 19:20; Rev 12:9; Rev 13:8; 2 Thess 2:4
v16 — Rev 20:4; Rev 19:20; Ezek 9:4; Rev 14:9-11; Deut 6:8
v17 — Rev 13:16; Rev 15:2; Rev 14:11; Rev 13:18; Rev 22:4
v18 — Rev 15:2; Rev 17:9; Rev 21:17; Dan 12:10; Rev 1:3

Chapter 14

John sees the Lamb standing on mount Sion with the hundred forty-four thousand who have His Father's name written on their foreheads. Three angels fly through heaven: the first proclaims the everlasting gospel, the second declares that Babylon is fallen, and the third warns that whoever receives the mark of the beast will drink of the wine of the wrath of God. The Son of man thrusts in His sickle and the earth is reaped.

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| <p>¹ <i>And I looked, and, lo, a Lamb stood on the mount Sion, and with him an hundred forty and four thousand, having his Father's name written in their foreheads.</i></p> | <p>Then I looked, and there before me was the Lamb, standing on Mount Zion, and with Him 144,000 who had His Father's name written on their foreheads.</p> |
| <p>² <i>And I heard a voice from heaven, as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of a great thunder: and I heard the voice of harpers harping with their harps:</i></p> | <p>And I heard a sound from heaven like the roar of rushing waters and like a loud peal of thunder. The sound I heard was like that of harpists playing their harps.</p> |
| <p>³ <i>And they sung as it were a new song before the throne, and before the four beasts, and the elders: and no man could learn that song but the hundred and forty and four thousand, which were redeemed from the earth.</i></p> | <p>They sang a new song before the throne and before the four living creatures and the elders. No one could learn the song except the 144,000 who had been redeemed from the earth.</p> |

- 4 *These are they which were not defiled with women; for they are virgins. These are they which follow the Lamb whithersoever he goeth. These were redeemed from among men, being the firstfruits unto God and to the Lamb.* These are those who did not defile themselves with women, for they remained virgins. They follow the Lamb wherever He goes. They were purchased from among mankind and offered as firstfruits to God and the Lamb.
- 5 *And in their mouth was found no guile: for they are without fault before the throne of God.* And in their mouth was found no guile, for they are without fault before the throne of God.
- 6 *And I saw another angel fly in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach unto them that dwell on the earth, and to every nation, and kindred, and tongue, and people,* Then I saw another angel flying in midair, and he had the eternal gospel to proclaim to those who live on the earth — to every nation, tribe, language and people.
- 7 *Saying with a loud voice, Fear God, and give glory to him; for the hour of his judgment is come: and worship him that made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and the fountains of waters.* He said in a loud voice, "Fear God and give Him glory, because the hour of His judgment has come. Worship Him who made the heavens, the earth, the sea and the springs of water."
- 8 *And there followed another angel, saying, Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication.* A second angel followed and said, "Fallen! Fallen is Babylon the Great, which made all the nations drink the maddening wine of her adulteries."
- 9 *And the third angel followed them, saying with a loud voice, If any man worship the beast and his image, and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand,* A third angel followed them and said in a loud voice: "If anyone worships the beast and its image and receives its mark on their forehead or hand,

- 10 *The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is poured out without mixture into the cup of his indignation; and he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone in the presence of the holy angels, and in the presence of the Lamb:* they, too, will drink the wine of God's fury, which has been poured full strength into the cup of His wrath. They will be tormented with burning sulfur in the presence of the holy angels and of the Lamb.
- 11 *And the smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever: and they have no rest day nor night, who worship the beast and his image, and whosoever receiveth the mark of his name.* And the smoke of their torment will rise for ever and ever. There will be no rest day or night for those who worship the beast and its image, or for anyone who receives the mark of its name."
- 12 *Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.* This calls for patient endurance on the part of the people of God Who keep His commandments and remain faithful to Jesus.
- 13 *And I heard a voice from heaven saying unto me, Write, Blessed are the dead which die in the Lord from henceforth: Yea, saith the Spirit, that they may rest from their labours; and their works do follow them.* Then I heard a voice from heaven say, "Write this: Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord from now on." "Yes," says the Spirit, "they will rest from their labor, for their deeds will follow them."
- 14 *And I looked, and behold a white cloud, and upon the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle.* I looked, and there before me was a white cloud, and seated on the cloud was one like a son of man with a crown of gold on His head and a sharp sickle in His hand.
- 15 *And another angel came out of the temple, crying with a loud voice to him that sat on the cloud, Thrust in thy sickle, and reap: for the time is come for thee to reap; for the harvest of the earth is ripe.* Then another angel came out of the temple and called in a loud voice to Him who was sitting on the cloud, "Take Your sickle and reap, because the time to reap has come, for the harvest of the earth is ripe."

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| <p>16 <i>And he that sat on the cloud thrust in his sickle on the earth; and the earth was reaped.</i></p> <p>17 <i>And another angel came out of the temple which is in heaven, he also having a sharp sickle.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And another angel came out from the altar, which had power over fire; and cried with a loud cry to him that had the sharp sickle, saying, Thrust in thy sharp sickle, and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth; for her grapes are fully ripe.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the angel thrust in his sickle into the earth, and gathered the vine of the earth, and cast it into the great winepress of the wrath of God.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And the winepress was trodden without the city, and blood came out of the winepress, even unto the horse bridles, by the space of a thousand and six hundred furlongs.</i></p> | <p>So He who was seated on the cloud swung his sickle over the earth, and the earth was harvested.</p> <p>Another angel came out of the temple in heaven, and He too had a sharp sickle.</p> <p>Still another angel, who had charge of the fire, came from the altar and called in a loud voice to Him who had the sharp sickle, "Take Your sharp sickle and gather the clusters of grapes from the earth's vine, because its grapes are ripe."</p> <p>The angel swung his sickle on the earth, gathered its grapes and threw them into the great winepress of God's wrath.</p> <p>They were trampled in the winepress outside the city, and blood flowed out of the press, rising as high as the horses' bridles for a distance of 1,600 stadia.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

firstfruits — The first portion of the harvest offered to God — acknowledging that all produce belongs to Him and comes from His hand.

Zion (ZY-on) — A hill in Jerusalem — originally the Jebusite fortress David captured; later used poetically for Jerusalem itself, and in the NT for the heavenly city.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Joel 2:32; Rev 3:12; Rev 7:3-17; Luke 12:8; Heb 12:22-24
- v2 — Rev 5:8; Ezek 43:2; Rev 1:15; Rev 15:2; Rev 11:15
- v3 — Rev 5:9; Rev 14:1; Rev 15:3; Isa 42:10; Ps 98:1
- v4 — Rev 3:4; 2 Cor 11:2; Jas 1:18; John 10:27; John 12:26
- v5 — Eph 5:27; Ps 32:2; Zeph 3:13; John 1:47; Jude 1:24
- v6 — Mark 16:15; Rev 8:13; Eph 3:9-11; Ps 139:24; Isa 51:8
- v7 — Ex 20:11; Rev 15:4; Neh 9:6; Rev 4:11; Rev 11:18

- v10** — Isa 51:17; Rev 16:19; Ps 75:8; Ps 11:6; Jer 25:15-17
v11 — Isa 34:10; Rev 19:3; Matt 25:46; Matt 25:41; Rev 20:10
v12 — Rev 13:10; Rev 12:17; Rev 3:10; Rev 3:8; 2 Tim 4:7
v13 — Rev 20:6; 1 Thess 5:10; 2 Tim 4:7-8; Heb 4:9-11; 1 Cor 15:58
v15 — Joel 3:13; Matt 13:39; Mark 4:29; Jer 51:33; Matt 13:30

Chapter 15

John sees seven angels having the seven last plagues, in which the wrath of God is filled up. Those who have gotten victory over the beast stand on a sea of glass mingled with fire, singing the song of Moses and the song of the Lamb. The temple of the tabernacle of the testimony in heaven is opened, and the seven angels are given seven golden vials full of the wrath of God.

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| <p>1 <i>And I saw another sign in heaven, great and marvellous, seven angels having the seven last plagues; for in them is filled up the wrath of God.</i></p> | <p>Then I saw another sign in heaven, great and marvellous: seven angels carrying the seven last plagues. With these, the wrath of God is complete.</p> |
| <p>2 <i>And I saw as it were a sea of glass mingled with fire: and them that had gotten the victory over the beast, and over his image, and over his mark, and over the number of his name, stand on the sea of glass, having the harps of God.</i></p> | <p>I saw what looked like a sea of glass mixed with fire. Standing on the sea of glass were those who had been victorious over the beast and its image and over the number of its name. They held the harps of God.</p> |
| <p>3 <i>And they sing the song of Moses the servant of God, and the song of the Lamb, saying, Great and marvellous are thy works, Lord God Almighty; just and true are thy ways, thou King of saints.</i></p> | <p>They sang the song of Moses the servant of God and the song of the Lamb, saying: "Great and marvellous are Your works, Lord God Almighty. Just and true are Your ways, O King of saints.</p> |
| <p>4 <i>Who shall not fear thee, O Lord, and glorify thy name? for thou only art holy: for all nations shall come and worship before thee; for thy judgments are made manifest.</i></p> | <p>Who shall not fear You, O Lord, and glorify Your name? For You alone are holy. All nations shall come and worship before You, for Your judgments have been made manifest."</p> |
| <p>5 <i>And after that I looked, and, behold, the temple of the tabernacle of the testimony in heaven was opened:</i></p> | <p>After this I looked, and the temple of the tabernacle of the testimony in heaven was opened.</p> |

6	<i>And the seven angels came out of the temple, having the seven plagues, clothed in pure and white linen, and having their breasts girded with golden girdles.</i>	Out of the temple came the seven angels carrying the seven plagues. They were clothed in pure white linen and wore golden sashes around their chests.
7	<i>And one of the four beasts gave unto the seven angels seven golden vials full of the wrath of God, who liveth for ever and ever.</i>	Then one of the four living creatures gave to the seven angels seven golden vials full of the wrath of God, Who lives for ever and ever.
8	<i>And the temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God, and from his power; and no man could enter into the temple, till the seven plagues of the seven angels were fulfilled.</i>	The temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God and from His power. No one could enter the temple until the seven plagues of the seven angels were fulfilled.

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Lev 26:21; Rev 15:6-7; Rev 21:9; Dan 4:2-3
- v2 — Rev 4:6; Rev 12:11; Rev 5:8; Rev 19:1-7; Rev 21:18
- v3 — Ps 111:2; Ex 15:1-18; Ps 139:14; Rev 5:9-13; Ps 145:17
- v4 — Ps 86:9; Jer 10:7; Mal 1:11; Ps 22:27; Rev 11:15
- v5 — Rev 11:19; Num 1:50; Matt 27:51
- v6 — Rev 1:13; Rev 15:1
- v8 — Isa 6:4; 1 Kgs 8:10-11; Ex 40:34-35; 2 Chr 5:13-14

Chapter 16

The seven vials of God's wrath are poured out. The first brings sores, the second and third turn the sea and rivers to blood, the fourth scorches men with fire, the fifth brings darkness on the beast's kingdom, the sixth dries up the Euphrates to prepare the way for the kings of the east, and the seventh brings the greatest earthquake in history and the fall of great Babylon.

1	<i>And I heard a great voice out of the temple saying to the seven angels, Go your ways, and pour out the vials of the wrath of God upon the earth.</i>	I heard a loud voice from the temple saying to the seven angels, "Go and pour out the seven bowls of God's wrath on the earth."
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- 2 *And the first went, and poured out his vial upon the earth; and there fell a noisome and grievous sore upon the men which had the mark of the beast, and upon them which worshipped his image.* The first angel went and poured out his bowl on the earth. Painful, ugly sores broke out on the people who had the mark of the beast and who worshiped his image.
- 3 *And the second angel poured out his vial upon the sea; and it became as the blood of a dead man: and every living soul died in the sea.* The second angel poured out his bowl on the sea. It turned to blood like that of a dead man, and every living creature in the sea died.
- 4 *And the third angel poured out his vial upon the rivers and fountains of waters; and they became blood.* The third angel poured out his bowl on the rivers and springs of water, and they turned to blood.
- 5 *And I heard the angel of the waters say, Thou art righteous, O Lord, which art, and wast, and shalt be, because thou hast judged thus.* I heard the angel of the waters say, "You are righteous, O Lord — You who are, and were, and are to come — because You have judged these things."
- 6 *For they have shed the blood of saints and prophets, and thou hast given them blood to drink; for they are worthy.* They shed the blood of saints and prophets, so You have given them blood to drink. They deserve it.
- 7 *And I heard another out of the altar say, Even so, Lord God Almighty, true and righteous are thy judgments.* I heard another voice from the altar say, "Yes, Lord God Almighty — Your judgments are true and righteous."
- 8 *And the fourth angel poured out his vial upon the sun; and power was given unto him to scorch men with fire.* The fourth angel poured out his bowl on the sun, and the sun was given power to scorch people with fire.
- 9 *And men were scorched with great heat, and blasphemed the name of God, which hath power over these plagues: and they repented not to give him glory.* People were seared by intense heat, and they cursed the name of God, Who had authority over these plagues. They refused to repent and give Him glory.

- 10 *And the fifth angel poured out his vial upon the seat of the beast; and his kingdom was full of darkness; and they gnawed their tongues for pain,* The fifth angel poured out his bowl on the throne of the beast, and his kingdom was plunged into darkness. People gnawed their tongues in agony
- 11 *And blasphemed the God of heaven because of their pains and their sores, and repented not of their deeds.* and cursed the God of heaven because of their pain and their sores. They refused to repent of what they had done.
- 12 *And the sixth angel poured out his vial upon the great river Euphrates; and the water thereof was dried up, that the way of the kings of the east might be prepared.* The sixth angel poured out his bowl on the great river Euphrates, and its water dried up to prepare the way for the kings of the east.
- 13 *And I saw three unclean spirits like frogs come out of the mouth of the dragon, and out of the mouth of the beast, and out of the mouth of the false prophet.* I saw three unclean spirits that looked like frogs come out of the mouth of the dragon, out of the mouth of the beast, and out of the mouth of the false prophet.
- 14 *For they are the spirits of devils, working miracles, which go forth unto the kings of the earth and of the whole world, to gather them to the battle of that great day of God Almighty.* These are demonic spirits that perform signs. They go out to the kings of the whole world to gather them for battle on the great day of God Almighty.
- 15 *Behold, I come as a thief. Blessed is he that watcheth, and keepeth his garments, lest he walk naked, and they see his shame.* "I am coming like a thief. Blessed is the one who stays alert and keeps his clothes ready, so he will not go naked and be exposed to shame."
- 16 *And he gathered them together into a place called in the Hebrew tongue Armageddon.* They were gathered to the place called Armageddon in the Hebrew language.
- 17 *And the seventh angel poured out his vial into the air; and there came a great voice out of the temple of heaven, from the throne, saying, It is done.* The seventh angel poured out his bowl into the air. A loud voice came from the throne in the temple of heaven, saying, "It is done!"

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| <p>18 <i>And there were voices, and thunders, and lightnings; and there was a great earthquake, such as was not since men were upon the earth, so mighty an earthquake, and so great.</i></p> <p>19 <i>And the great city was divided into three parts, and the cities of the nations fell: and great Babylon came in remembrance before God, to give unto her the cup of the wine of the fierceness of his wrath.</i></p> <p>20 <i>And every island fled away, and the mountains were not found.</i></p> <p>21 <i>And there fell upon men a great hail out of heaven, every stone about the weight of a talent: and men blasphemed God because of the plague of the hail; for the plague thereof was exceeding great.</i></p> | <p>There came flashes of lightning, rumblings, and thunder. A great earthquake struck — the most severe since mankind has been on the earth.</p> <p>The great city split into three parts, and the cities of the nations collapsed. God remembered great Babylon and gave her the cup filled with the wine of His fierce wrath.</p> <p>Every island fled away, and the mountains were gone.</p> <p>Enormous hailstones, each weighing about a talent, fell on people from heaven. They cursed God because of the plague of hail, for it was a terrible plague.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

Armageddon (*ar-mah-GED-on*) — From the Hebrew Har-Megiddo ('mountain of Megiddo') — the place named in Revelation 16:16 where the kings of the earth gather for the final battle.

Cross-References:

v1 — Zeph 3:8; Rev 15:1; Jer 10:25; Rev 16:17; Ps 79:6
v4 — Ex 7:17-20; Rev 8:10-11; Rev 14:7; Hos 13:15
v5 — Rev 11:17; Rev 1:8; Rev 1:4; Ps 145:17
v6 — Isa 49:26; Rev 6:10-11; Rev 11:18; Luke 11:49-50; Rev 18:24
v8 — Jonah 4:8; Luke 21:25; Rev 14:18; Acts 2:20; Rev 7:16
v9 — Rev 16:21; Rev 2:21; Luke 13:5; Rev 11:13; Jer 5:3
v11 — Rev 16:9; Rev 11:13; Rev 16:2; Rev 16:21
v13 — Rev 19:20; 2 Thess 2:9-11; Rev 20:10; 1 John 4:1-3; Rev 16:14
v14 — Rev 17:14; 1 Tim 4:1; Rev 20:8; Jas 3:15; 2 Cor 11:13-15
v15 — 1 Thess 5:2-3; Matt 24:42-43; 2 Pet 3:10; Rev 3:18; Rev 3:3-4
v19 — Rev 17:18; Rev 18:5; Rev 18:21; Rev 18:10
v21 — Rev 11:19; Rev 16:9; Josh 10:11; Rev 8:7; Rev 16:11

Chapter 17

John sees the great whore sitting on a scarlet-colored beast with seven heads and ten horns, arrayed in purple and scarlet, holding a golden cup full of abominations, with the name MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF HARLOTS written on her forehead. The angel explains that the seven heads are seven mountains and seven kings, and the ten horns will make war with the Lamb, but the Lamb shall overcome them.

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| 1 <i>And there came one of the seven angels which had the seven vials, and talked with me, saying unto me, Come hither; I will shew unto thee the judgment of the great whore that sitteth upon many waters:</i> | One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls came and spoke to me. "Come," he said, "I will show you the judgment of the great prostitute who sits on many waters." |
| 2 <i>With whom the kings of the earth have committed fornication, and the inhabitants of the earth have been made drunk with the wine of her fornication.</i> | The kings of the earth committed sexual immorality with her, and the people of the earth were made drunk with the wine of her immorality. |
| 3 <i>So he carried me away in the spirit into the wilderness: and I saw a woman sit upon a scarlet coloured beast, full of names of blasphemy, having seven heads and ten horns.</i> | He carried me away in the Spirit into a wilderness. I saw a woman sitting on a scarlet beast. The beast was covered with names of blasphemy and had seven heads and ten horns. |
| 4 <i>And the woman was arrayed in purple and scarlet colour, and decked with gold and precious stones and pearls, having a golden cup in her hand full of abominations and filthiness of her fornication:</i> | The woman was dressed in purple and scarlet and adorned with gold, precious stones, and pearls. She held a golden cup in her hand, filled with the abominations and filth of her immorality. |
| 5 <i>And upon her forehead was a name written, MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF HARLOTS AND ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH.</i> | On her forehead was written a name — a mystery: BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF PROSTITUTES AND OF THE ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH. |

- 6 *And I saw the woman drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs of Jesus: and when I saw her, I wondered with great admiration.* I saw the woman drunk with the blood of the saints and the blood of the martyrs of Jesus. When I saw her, I was greatly astonished.
- 7 *And the angel said unto me, Wherefore didst thou marvel? I will tell thee the mystery of the woman, and of the beast that carrieth her, which hath the seven heads and ten horns.* The angel said to me, "Why are you astonished? I will explain to you the mystery of the woman and of the beast she rides — the beast with seven heads and ten horns."
- 8 *The beast that thou sawest was, and is not; and shall ascend out of the bottomless pit, and go into perdition: and they that dwell on the earth shall wonder, whose names were not written in the book of life from the foundation of the world, when they behold the beast that was, and is not, and yet is.* The beast you saw once was, now is not, and will come up out of the bottomless pit before going to his destruction. The people of the earth — those whose names were not written in the book of life from the foundation of the world — will be astonished when they see the beast, because he was, is not, and yet will come.
- 9 *And here is the mind which hath wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains, on which the woman sitteth.* This calls for a mind that has wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains on which the woman sits.
- 10 *And there are seven kings: five are fallen, and one is, and the other is not yet come; and when he cometh, he must continue a short space.* They are also seven kings. Five have fallen, one is reigning now, and the other has not yet come. When he does come, he must remain only a short while.
- 11 *And the beast that was, and is not, even he is the eighth, and is of the seven, and goeth into perdition.* The beast who once was, and now is not, is himself an eighth king. He belongs to the seven, and he goes to his destruction.

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| <p>12 <i>And the ten horns which thou sawest are ten kings, which have received no kingdom as yet; but receive power as kings one hour with the beast.</i></p> <p>13 <i>These have one mind, and shall give their power and strength unto the beast.</i></p> <p>14 <i>These shall make war with the Lamb, and the Lamb shall overcome them: for he is Lord of lords, and King of kings: and they that are with him are called, and chosen, and faithful.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And he saith unto me, The waters which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues.</i></p> <p>16 <i>And the ten horns which thou sawest upon the beast, these shall hate the whore, and shall make her desolate and naked, and shall eat her flesh, and burn her with fire.</i></p> <p>17 <i>For God hath put in their hearts to fulfil his will, and to agree, and give their kingdom unto the beast, until the words of God shall be fulfilled.</i></p> <p>18 <i>And the woman which thou sawest is that great city, which reigneth over the kings of the earth.</i></p> | <p>The ten horns you saw are ten kings who have not yet received a kingdom. They will receive authority as kings for one hour together with the beast.</p> <p>These kings all share one purpose, and they will give their power and authority to the beast.</p> <p>They will wage war against the Lamb, but the Lamb will overcome them — for He is Lord of lords and King of kings. Those with Him are called, chosen, and faithful.</p> <p>Then the angel said to me, "The waters where the prostitute sits are peoples, crowds, nations, and languages."</p> <p>The ten horns and the beast will hate the prostitute. They will make her desolate and naked, eat her flesh, and burn her with fire.</p> <p>God has put it in their hearts to carry out His purpose. They agreed to give their power to the beast until God's words are fulfilled.</p> <p>The woman you saw is the great city that rules over the kings of the earth.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

mystery (*MIS-tur-ee*) — a truth hidden in God's plan, now revealed; written on the forehead of Babylon the Great

Babylon (*BAB-ih-lon*) — the great city that symbolizes the world system opposed to God; called the mother of harlots

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 19:2; Jer 51:13; Rev 17:1-17; Rev 16:19; Rev 21:9
- v2 — Rev 14:8; Jer 51:7; Rev 18:3; Rev 18:9
- v3 — Rev 12:3; Rev 13:1-6; Rev 17:6-7; Rev 12:6; Rev 17:9-12
- v4 — Rev 18:16; Jer 51:7; Rev 19:2; Rev 18:12; 2 Thess 2:3-10
- v5 — Rev 14:8; Rev 18:2; Rev 17:7; Rev 16:19; Rev 19:2
- v6 — Rev 16:6; Rev 13:15; Rev 2:13
- v8 — Rev 11:7; Rev 17:11; Rev 19:15-21; Rev 3:10; Rev 9:1-2
- v12 — Rev 12:3; Rev 13:1; Zech 1:18-21; Dan 7:24; Rev 17:16
- v14 — Rom 8:30; 1 Tim 6:15; Matt 22:14; Rev 3:21; Dan 2:47
- v15 — Rev 17:1; Jer 51:55; Isa 8:7-8; Jer 51:13
- v16 — Rev 18:8; Ezek 16:37-44; Lev 21:9; Jer 50:41-42
- v17 — 2 Thess 2:10-12; Prov 21:1; Rev 10:7; 2 Cor 8:16

Chapter 18

An angel announces the fall of Babylon the great, which is become the habitation of devils and the hold of every foul spirit. A voice from heaven calls God's people to come out of her, and the merchants and kings of the earth weep and mourn over her destruction, for in one hour so great riches is come to nought. Heaven and the holy apostles and prophets rejoice, for God has avenged them on her.

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| 1 | <i>And after these things I saw another angel come down from heaven, having great power; and the earth was lightened with his glory.</i> | After this I saw another angel coming down from heaven. He had great authority, and the earth was lit up by his glory. |
| 2 | <i>And he cried mightily with a strong voice, saying, Babylon the great is fallen, is fallen, and is become the habitation of devils, and the hold of every foul spirit, and a cage of every unclean and hateful bird.</i> | He cried out in a mighty voice: "Fallen! Fallen is Babylon the great! She has become a home for demons and a haunt for every unclean spirit — a cage for every unclean and hateful bird." |
| 3 | <i>For all nations have drunk of the wine of the wrath of her fornication, and the kings of the earth have committed fornication with her, and the merchants of the earth are waxed rich through the abundance of her delicacies.</i> | All the nations drank the wine of the wrath of her immorality. The kings of the earth committed immorality with her. The merchants of the earth grew rich from the power of her excessive pleasures. |

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| 4 <i>And I heard another voice from heaven, saying, Come out of her, my people, that ye be not partakers of her sins, and that ye receive not of her plagues.</i> | I heard another voice from heaven say: "Come out of her, my people, so that you will not share in her sins or receive any of her plagues." |
| 5 <i>For her sins have reached unto heaven, and God hath remembered her iniquities.</i> | Her sins have piled up to heaven, and God has remembered her iniquities. |
| 6 <i>Reward her even as she rewarded you, and double unto her double according to her works: in the cup which she hath filled fill to her double.</i> | Pay her back as she has paid others. Give her double for what she has done. In the cup she mixed for others, pour her double the amount. |
| 7 <i>How much she hath glorified herself, and lived deliciously, so much torment and sorrow give her: for she saith in her heart, I sit a queen, and am no widow, and shall see no sorrow.</i> | Give her the same measure of torment and grief as the glory and luxury she gave herself. In her heart she says, "I sit as queen. I am not a widow, and I will never mourn." |
| 8 <i>Therefore shall her plagues come in one day, death, and mourning, and famine; and she shall be utterly burned with fire: for strong is the Lord God who judgeth her.</i> | Therefore her plagues will come in a single day — death, mourning, and famine. She will be burned up with fire, for mighty is the Lord God Who judges her. |
| 9 <i>And the kings of the earth, who have committed fornication and lived deliciously with her, shall bewail her, and lament for her, when they shall see the smoke of her burning,</i> | The kings of the earth who committed immorality and shared in her luxury will weep and mourn over her when they see the smoke of her burning. |
| 10 <i>Standing afar off for the fear of her torment, saying, Alas, alas, that great city Babylon, that mighty city! for in one hour is thy judgment come.</i> | They will stand far off in fear of her torment and cry out: "How terrible, how terrible — that great city, Babylon, that mighty city! In just one hour your judgment has come!" |

- 11 *And the merchants of the earth shall weep and mourn over her; for no man buyeth their merchandise any more:* The merchants of the earth will weep and mourn over her, because no one buys their goods any longer —
- 12 *The merchandise of gold, and silver, and precious stones, and of pearls, and fine linen, and purple, and silk, and scarlet, and all thyine wood, and all manner vessels of ivory, and all manner vessels of most precious wood, and of brass, and iron, and marble,* goods of gold, silver, precious stones, and pearls; fine linen, purple, silk, and scarlet cloth; every kind of citron wood; articles of ivory, costly wood, bronze, iron, and marble;
- 13 *And cinnamon, and odours, and ointments, and frankincense, and wine, and oil, and fine flour, and wheat, and beasts, and sheep, and horses, and chariots, and slaves, and souls of men.* cinnamon, spice, incense, myrrh, and frankincense; wine, olive oil, fine flour, and wheat; cattle, sheep, horses, and carriages; and human lives — the souls of people.
- 14 *And the fruits that thy soul lusted after are departed from thee, and all things which were dainty and goodly are departed from thee, and thou shalt find them no more at all.* The fruit you craved is gone from you. All your luxury and splendor are lost to you — you will never find them again.
- 15 *The merchants of these things, which were made rich by her, shall stand afar off for the fear of her torment, weeping and wailing,* The merchants who sold these things and grew rich from her will stand far off, terrified at her torment, weeping and mourning.
- 16 *And saying, Alas, alas, that great city, that was clothed in fine linen, and purple, and scarlet, and decked with gold, and precious stones, and pearls!* They will cry out: "How terrible, how terrible — that great city, dressed in fine linen, purple, and scarlet, and adorned with gold, precious stones, and pearls!"

- 17 *For in one hour so great riches is come to nought. And every shipmaster, and all the company in ships, and sailors, and as many as trade by sea, stood afar off,* In just one hour all that wealth has been destroyed! Every sea captain, every passenger, every sailor, and everyone who works on the sea stood far off
- 18 *And cried when they saw the smoke of her burning, saying, What city is like unto this great city!* and cried out when they saw the smoke of her burning: "What city was ever like this great city?"
- 19 *And they cast dust on their heads, and cried, weeping and wailing, saying, Alas, alas, that great city, wherein were made rich all that had ships in the sea by reason of her costliness! for in one hour is she made desolate.* They threw dust on their heads and cried out, weeping and mourning: "How terrible, how terrible — that great city, where all who had ships at sea grew rich from her wealth! In just one hour she has been destroyed!"
- 20 *Rejoice over her, thou heaven, and ye holy apostles and prophets; for God hath avenged you on her.* Rejoice over her, O heaven, and you holy apostles and prophets! God has judged her for the way she treated you.
- 21 *And a mighty angel took up a stone like a great millstone, and cast it into the sea, saying, Thus with violence shall that great city Babylon be thrown down, and shall be found no more at all.* Then a mighty angel picked up a boulder the size of a large millstone and threw it into the sea, saying: "With this same violence the great city of Babylon will be thrown down, never to be found again."
- 22 *And the voice of harpers, and musicians, and of pipers, and trumpeters, shall be heard no more at all in thee; and no craftsman, of whatsoever craft he be, shall be found any more in thee; and the sound of a millstone shall be heard no more at all in thee;* The music of harpists and musicians, flute players and trumpeters, will never be heard in you again. No craftsman of any trade will ever be found in you again. The sound of a millstone will never be heard in you again.

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| <p>23 <i>And the light of a candle shall shine no more at all in thee; and the voice of the bridegroom and of the bride shall be heard no more at all in thee: for thy merchants were the great men of the earth; for by thy sorceries were all nations deceived.</i></p> | <p>The light of a lamp will never shine in you again. The voice of a bridegroom and bride will never be heard in you again. Your merchants were the great men of the earth, and all the nations were deceived by your sorceries.</p> |
| <p>24 <i>And in her was found the blood of prophets, and of saints, and of all that were slain upon the earth.</i></p> | <p>In her was found the blood of prophets and saints — and of all who have been killed on the earth.</p> |

Words in this chapter:

incense — A fragrant offering burned on the golden altar in the tabernacle — symbolizing the prayers of God's people rising before Him.

Cross-References:

- v2 — Jer 51:8; Rev 14:8; Jer 51:37; Jer 50:39-40; Jer 51:60-64
- v3 — Rev 14:8; Rev 17:2; Rev 18:9; Rev 18:23; Jer 51:7
- v4 — 2 Cor 6:17; Isa 52:11; Jer 51:6; Jer 51:45; Jer 50:8
- v5 — Ezra 9:6; Gen 18:20-21; Jer 51:9; Rev 16:19; Jonah 1:2
- v6 — Jer 50:29; Ps 137:8; Jer 51:24; Jer 50:15; Rev 14:10
- v7 — Isa 47:7-9; Zeph 2:15; Lam 1:1; Ezek 28:2-10
- v9 — Rev 19:3; Rev 18:3; Rev 17:2; Rev 18:18; Ezek 26:16-17
- v10 — Rev 18:19; Rev 18:8; Rev 18:15-17; Rev 14:8; Amos 5:16
- v13 — Ezek 27:13; Amos 2:6; 2 Pet 2:3; Neh 5:8
- v19 — Rev 18:10; Josh 7:6; Ezek 27:30; Job 2:12; Rev 18:3
- v23 — Rev 18:3; Nah 3:4; Isa 23:8; Jer 7:34; Rev 22:15
- v24 — Rev 17:6; Rev 16:6; Jer 51:49; Rev 19:2; Acts 7:52

Chapter 19

A great multitude in heaven cries "Alleluia!" and the marriage supper of the Lamb is come. John sees heaven opened, and One called Faithful and True rides forth on a white horse — His name is THE WORD OF GOD, and on His vesture and thigh is written KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS. The beast and the false prophet are cast alive into the lake of fire burning with brimstone.

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| 1 | <i>And after these things I heard a great voice of much people in heaven, saying, Alleluia; Salvation, and glory, and honour, and power, unto the Lord our God:</i> | And after these things I heard a great voice of much people in heaven, saying, "Alleluia! Salvation, and glory, and honour, and power, to the Lord our God; |
| 2 | <i>For true and righteous are his judgments: for he hath judged the great whore, which did corrupt the earth with her fornication, and hath avenged the blood of his servants at her hand.</i> | "His judgments are true and righteous. He has judged the great prostitute who corrupted the earth with her immorality. He has avenged the blood of His servants shed by her hand." |
| 3 | <i>And again they said, Alleluia. And her smoke rose up for ever and ever.</i> | And again they said, "Alleluia!" And her smoke rose up for ever and ever. |
| 4 | <i>And the four and twenty elders and the four beasts fell down and worshipped God that sat on the throne, saying, Amen; Alleluia.</i> | And the four and twenty elders and the four living creatures fell down and worshipped God Who sat on the throne, saying, "Amen, Alleluia!" |
| 5 | <i>And a voice came out of the throne, saying, Praise our God, all ye his servants, and ye that fear him, both small and great.</i> | A voice came from the throne, saying: "Praise our God, all You His servants, you who fear him, both small and great!" |
| 6 | <i>And I heard as it were the voice of a great multitude, and as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of mighty thunderings, saying, Alleluia: for the Lord God omnipotent reigneth.</i> | And I heard as it were the voice of a great crowd, and as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of mighty thunderings, saying, "Alleluia! For the Lord God omnipotent reigns!" |
| 7 | <i>Let us be glad and rejoice, and give honour to him: for the marriage of the Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready.</i> | "Let us be glad and rejoice and give Him glory! For the marriage of the Lamb has come, and His bride has made herself ready." |
| 8 | <i>And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, clean and white: for the fine linen is the righteousness of saints.</i> | She was given fine linen, bright and clean, to wear. The fine linen stands for the righteous deeds of the saints. |

- 9 *And he saith unto me, Write, Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb. And he saith unto me, These are the true sayings of God.* Then the angel said to me, "Write this: Blessed are those who are invited to the marriage supper of the Lamb!" He added, "These are the true words of God."
- 10 *And I fell at his feet to worship him. And he said unto me, See thou do it not: I am thy fellowservant, and of thy brethren that have the testimony of Jesus: worship God: for the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.* I fell at His feet to worship Him, but He said to me, "Do not do that! I am a fellow servant with You and Your brothers who hold the testimony of Jesus. Worship God! For the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy."
- 11 *And I saw heaven opened, and behold a white horse; and he that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he doth judge and make war.* I saw heaven standing open, and there before me was a white horse. Its rider is called Faithful and True. He judges and makes war in righteousness.
- 12 *His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on his head were many crowns; and he had a name written, that no man knew, but he himself.* His eyes are like blazing fire, and on His head are many crowns. He has a name written on Him that no one knows but himself.
- 13 *And he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God.* He is dressed in clothing dipped in blood, and His name is called The Word of God.
- 14 *And the armies which were in heaven followed him upon white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean.* The armies of heaven followed Him on white horses, dressed in fine linen, white and clean.
- 15 *And out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God.* Out of His mouth comes a sharp sword to strike down the nations. He will rule them with a rod of iron. He treads the winepress of the fierce wrath of God Almighty.
- 16 *And he hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.* On His clothing and on His thigh is written: KING OF KINGS AND LORD OF LORDS.

- 17 *And I saw an angel standing in the sun; and he cried with a loud voice, saying to all the fowls that fly in the midst of heaven, Come and gather yourselves together unto the supper of the great God;* I saw an angel standing in the sun. He cried out in a loud voice to all the birds flying in midair, "Come! Gather together for the great supper of God."
- 18 *That ye may eat the flesh of kings, and the flesh of captains, and the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses, and of them that sit on them, and the flesh of all men, both free and bond, both small and great.* "Come and eat the flesh of kings, generals, and mighty men — the flesh of horses and their riders — the flesh of all people, free and slave, small and great."
- 19 *And I saw the beast, and the kings of the earth, and their armies, gathered together to make war against him that sat on the horse, and against his army.* I saw the beast and the kings of the earth and their armies gathered together to wage war against the rider on the horse and His army.
- 20 *And the beast was taken, and with him the false prophet that wrought miracles before him, with which he deceived them that had received the mark of the beast, and them that worshipped his image. These both were cast alive into a lake of fire burning with brimstone.* The beast was captured, and with him the false prophet who had performed signs on his behalf — the signs by which he had deceived those who received the mark of the beast and worshiped his image. The two of them were thrown alive into the lake of fire burning with brimstone.
- 21 *And the remnant were slain with the sword of him that sat upon the horse, which sword proceeded out of his mouth: and all the fowls were filled with their flesh.* The rest were killed by the sword that came out of the mouth of the rider on the horse. All the birds gorged themselves on their flesh.

Words in this chapter:

Alleluia (*al-eh-LOO-yah*) — Greek transliteration of Hebrew Hallelujah, 'Praise the LORD' — a shout of praise using God's name Yah (short for YHWH); KJV preserves the Greek form in Revelation.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Rev 7:10-12; 1 Chr 29:11; Rev 11:15; Matt 6:13; Rev 5:9-13
- v2 — Deut 32:43; Rev 6:10; Rev 16:5-7; Rev 18:20; Deut 32:35
- v7 — Rev 21:2; Rev 21:9; Rev 19:9; Matt 22:2; 2 Cor 11:2
- v8 — Isa 61:10; Rev 7:13-14; Ps 132:9; Eph 5:26-27; Rev 3:18
- v10 — Rev 22:8-9; Acts 10:25-26; John 5:39; Heb 1:14; Rev 4:10
- v11 — Ps 96:13; Isa 11:3-5; Ps 98:9; Rev 6:2; Ps 50:6
- v12 — Rev 19:16; Luke 10:22; Rev 1:14; Rev 2:17-18; Matt 11:27
- v13 — John 1:1; Isa 63:1-6; John 1:14; Ps 58:10; Rev 14:20
- v14 — Jude 1:14; Rev 7:9; Rev 17:14; Rev 19:8; Matt 28:3
- v15 — Isa 63:2-6; Rev 1:16; Rev 2:27; 2 Thess 2:8; Ps 2:9
- v16 — Rev 17:14; 1 Tim 6:15; Dan 2:47; Phil 2:9-11; Rev 19:12-13
- v20 — Rev 20:10; Rev 21:8; 2 Thess 2:8-11; Dan 7:7-14; Rev 20:14-15

Chapter 20

An angel binds Satan for a thousand years and casts him into the bottomless pit, and the saints reign with Christ for the thousand years. After the thousand years Satan is loosed, deceives the nations, and gathers them to battle, but fire comes down from God out of heaven and devours them, and the devil is cast into the lake of fire. John sees the great white throne judgment: the dead are judged according to their works, and whosoever is not found written in the book of life is cast into the lake of fire.

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| 1 | <i>And I saw an angel come down from heaven, having the key of the bottomless pit and a great chain in his hand.</i> | I saw an angel come down from heaven. He held the key to the bottomless pit and a great chain in His hand. |
| 2 | <i>And he laid hold on the dragon, that old serpent, which is the Devil, and Satan, and bound him a thousand years,</i> | He seized the dragon — that ancient serpent, who is the Devil and Satan — and bound him for a thousand years. |
| 3 | <i>And cast him into the bottomless pit, and shut him up, and set a seal upon him, that he should deceive the nations no more, till the thousand years should be fulfilled: and after that he must be loosed a little season.</i> | He threw him into the bottomless pit, shut it, and sealed it over him so he could no longer deceive the nations. This would last until the thousand years were complete. After that, he must be released for a short time. |

- 4 *And I saw thrones, and they sat upon them, and judgment was given unto them: and I saw the souls of them that were beheaded for the witness of Jesus, and for the word of God, and which had not worshipped the beast, neither his image, neither had received his mark upon their foreheads, or in their hands; and they lived and reigned with Christ a thousand years.* I saw thrones, and those who sat on them were given authority to judge. I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded for their witness to Jesus and for the word of God. They had not worshipped the beast or his image, and had not received his mark on their foreheads or hands. They came to life and reigned with Christ for a thousand years.
- 5 *But the rest of the dead lived not again until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection.* The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were ended. This is the first resurrection.
- 6 *Blessed and holy is he that hath part in the first resurrection: on such the second death hath no power, but they shall be priests of God and of Christ, and shall reign with him a thousand years.* Blessed and holy is everyone who has part in the first resurrection. The second death has no power over them. They will be priests of God and of Christ, and will reign with Him a thousand years.
- 7 *And when the thousand years are expired, Satan shall be loosed out of his prison,* When the thousand years are over, Satan will be released from his prison.
- 8 *And shall go out to deceive the nations which are in the four quarters of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them together to battle: the number of whom is as the sand of the sea.* He will go out to deceive the nations at the four corners of the earth — Gog and Magog — and gather them for battle. Their number will be like the sand of the sea.
- 9 *And they went up on the breadth of the earth, and compassed the camp of the saints about, and the beloved city: and fire came down from God out of heaven, and devoured them.* They spread out across the earth and surrounded the camp of God's people and the beloved city. But fire came down from God out of heaven and consumed them.

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| <p>10 <i>And the devil that deceived them was cast into the lake of fire and brimstone, where the beast and the false prophet are, and shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever.</i></p> <p>11 <i>And I saw a great white throne, and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them.</i></p> <p>12 <i>And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works.</i></p> <p>13 <i>And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.</i></p> <p>14 <i>And death and hell were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.</i></p> <p>15 <i>And whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.</i></p> | <p>The devil who had deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and brimstone, where the beast and the false prophet already were. They will be tormented day and night forever and ever.</p> <p>I saw a great white throne and the One who sat on it. The earth and the heaven fled from His face, and no place was found for them.</p> <p>I saw the dead, both small and great, standing before God. The books were opened, and another book was opened — the book of life. The dead were judged according to what was written in the books, according to their works.</p> <p>The sea gave up its dead. Death and hell gave up the dead that were in them. Every person was judged according to their works.</p> <p>Then death and hell were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death.</p> <p>Anyone whose name was not found written in the book of life was thrown into the lake of fire.</p> |
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Words in this chapter:

dragon — In the OT (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel), 'dragon' is often used for a great sea-serpent and as a symbol of Egypt or chaos; in Revelation, the dragon is Satan himself.

Cross-References:

v2 — 2 Pet 2:4; Rev 12:9; Isa 27:1; Jude 1:6; John 12:31

v3 — Rev 20:1; Rev 17:8; 2 Thess 2:9-11; Dan 6:17; Rev 12:9

- v4 — Dan 7:27; Dan 7:18; 1 Cor 6:2-3; Matt 19:28; 2 Tim 2:12
- v6 — Rev 2:11; Rev 1:6; 2 Tim 2:12; 1 Pet 2:9; Rev 5:10
- v8 — Ezek 38:1-39:1; Rev 16:14; Rev 20:10; Rev 20:3
- v9 — Ezek 38:16; Ezek 39:6; Ezek 38:22; Ezek 38:9; 2 Thess 1:8
- v10 — Matt 25:41; Rev 19:20; Matt 25:46; Rev 20:2-3; Rev 20:14-15
- v11 — Rev 21:1; 2 Pet 3:7; Dan 2:35; Matt 25:31; Rom 2:5
- v12 — 2 Cor 5:10; Matt 16:27; Dan 7:10; Eccl 12:14; Rev 2:23
- v13 — John 5:28-29; Rev 6:8; Hos 13:14
- v14 — 1 Cor 15:26; Rev 20:6; Rev 21:8; Rev 19:20; Rev 1:18
- v15 — John 3:36; Matt 13:50; Matt 25:41; 1 John 5:11-12; John 14:6

Chapter 21

John sees a new heaven and a new earth, and the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. God shall dwell with His people, and He shall wipe away all tears from their eyes — there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, nor pain. The city has no need of the sun or the moon, for the glory of God lightens it, and the Lamb is the light thereof.

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| 1 | <i>And I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea.</i> | I saw a new heaven and a new earth. The first heaven and the first earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. |
| 2 | <i>And I John saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.</i> | I, John, saw the holy city — the new Jerusalem — coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. |
| 3 | <i>And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God.</i> | I heard a loud voice from heaven say: "The tabernacle of God is now with men. He will live with them, and they will be His people. God Himself will be with them and be their God." |

■ **WORD NOTE** — **Tabernacle** (TAB-er-nak-ul) — *the tent where God's presence dwelt among His people in the wilderness. Here in Revelation the word takes on its ultimate meaning: God will personally dwell with His people forever, in a way the old tent could only point to.*

- 4 *And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for the former things are passed away.* God will wipe away every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death, sorrow, crying, or pain. All those former things will have passed away.
- 5 *And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful.* He who sat on the throne said, "I am making all things new." He said to me, "Write this down, for these words are true and faithful."
- 6 *And he said unto me, It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain of the water of life freely.* He said to me, "It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. To anyone who is thirsty, I will give freely from the fountain of the water of life."
- 7 *He that overcometh shall inherit all things; and I will be his God, and he shall be my son.* The one who overcomes will inherit all things. I will be his God, and He will be My son.
- 8 *But the fearful, and unbelieving, and the abominable, and murderers, and whoremongers, and sorcerers, and idolaters, and all liars, shall have their part in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone: which is the second death.* But the cowardly, the unbelieving, the abominable, murderers, the sexually immoral, sorcerers, idolaters, and all liars — their part will be in the lake that burns with fire and brimstone. This is the second death.
- 9 *And there came unto me one of the seven angels which had the seven vials full of the seven last plagues, and talked with me, saying, Come hither, I will shew thee the bride, the Lamb's wife.* One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls full of the seven last plagues came and spoke to me, saying, "Come, I will show you the bride, the wife of the Lamb."

- 10 *And he carried me away in the spirit to a great and high mountain, and shewed me that great city, the holy Jerusalem, descending out of heaven from God,* He carried me away in the Spirit to a great and high mountain and showed me the great city, the holy Jerusalem, descending out of heaven from God.
- 11 *Having the glory of God: and her light was like unto a stone most precious, even like a jasper stone, clear as crystal;* It shone with the glory of God. Its light was like that of a most precious stone — like a jasper, clear as crystal.
- 12 *And had a wall great and high, and had twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and names written thereon, which are the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel:* It had a great and high wall with twelve gates. At the gates were twelve angels, and the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel were written on the gates.
- 13 *On the east three gates; on the north three gates; on the south three gates; and on the west three gates.* On the east were three gates, on the north three gates, on the south three gates, and on the west three gates.
- 14 *And the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and in them the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.* The wall of the city had twelve foundations, and on them were the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.
- 15 *And he that talked with me had a golden reed to measure the city, and the gates thereof, and the wall thereof.* The angel who spoke with me had a golden measuring rod to measure the city, its gates, and its wall.
- 16 *And the city lieth foursquare, and the length is as large as the breadth: and he measured the city with the reed, twelve thousand furlongs. The length and the breadth and the height of it are equal.* The city was laid out as a square — its length the same as its width. He measured the city with the rod: twelve thousand furlongs. Its length, width, and height were all equal.
- 17 *And he measured the wall thereof, an hundred and forty and four cubits, according to the measure of a man, that is, of the angel.* He measured the wall as well: one hundred and forty-four cubits, by human measurement, which the angel used.

- 18 *And the building of the wall of it was of jasper: and the city was pure gold, like unto clear glass.* The wall was built of jasper, and the city itself was pure gold, clear as glass.
- 19 *And the foundations of the wall of the city were garnished with all manner of precious stones. The first foundation was jasper; the second, sapphire; the third, a chalcedony; the fourth, an emerald;* The foundations of the city wall were decorated with every kind of precious stone. The first foundation was jasper, the second sapphire, the third chalcedony, the fourth emerald,
- 20 *The fifth, sardonyx; the sixth, sardius; the seventh, chrysolyte; the eighth, beryl; the ninth, a topaz; the tenth, a chrysoprasus; the eleventh, a jacinth; the twelfth, an amethyst.* the fifth sardonyx, the sixth sardius, the seventh chrysolyte, the eighth beryl, the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprasus, the eleventh jacinth, the twelfth amethyst.
- 21 *And the twelve gates were twelve pearls; every several gate was of one pearl: and the street of the city was pure gold, as it were transparent glass.* The twelve gates were twelve pearls — each gate made from a single pearl. The main street of the city was pure gold, transparent as glass.
- 22 *And I saw no temple therein: for the Lord God Almighty and the Lamb are the temple of it.* I saw no temple in the city, for the Lord God Almighty and the Lamb are its temple.
- 23 *And the city had no need of the sun, neither of the moon, to shine in it: for the glory of God did lighten it, and the Lamb is the light thereof.* The city has no need of the sun or moon to shine on it, for the glory of God gives it light, and the Lamb is its lamp.
- 24 *And the nations of them which are saved shall walk in the light of it: and the kings of the earth do bring their glory and honour into it.* The nations of those who are saved will walk in its light, and the kings of the earth will bring their glory and honor into it.
- 25 *And the gates of it shall not be shut at all by day: for there shall be no night there.* Its gates will never be shut by day — and there will be no night there.

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| 26 | <i>And they shall bring the glory and honour of the nations into it.</i> | The glory and honor of the nations will be brought into it. |
| 27 | <i>And there shall in no wise enter into it any thing that defileth, neither whatsoever worketh abomination, or maketh a lie: but they which are written in the Lamb's book of life.</i> | Nothing that defiles will ever enter it, nor anyone who does what is shameful or false. Only those who are written in the Lamb's book of life will enter. |

Words in this chapter:

tabernacle — The tent of meeting — Israel's portable worship structure in the wilderness where God's presence dwelt among His people.

Cross-References:

- v1 — Isa 65:17-19; 2 Pet 3:13; Isa 66:22; Rev 21:5; 2 Pet 3:10
- v2 — Heb 11:10; Rev 3:12; Rev 21:10; Heb 13:14; Isa 61:10
- v3 — Ezek 37:27; 2 Cor 6:16; John 14:23; Lev 26:11-12; Zech 8:8
- v4 — Isa 25:8; Rev 7:17; 1 Cor 15:26; Isa 35:10; Isa 60:20
- v5 — Isa 42:9; 2 Cor 5:17; Isa 43:19; Rev 19:9; Rev 4:2
- v6 — John 7:37-38; John 4:10; Rev 7:17; John 4:14; Ps 36:9
- v7 — 2 Cor 6:18; Heb 8:10; Rev 21:3; Rev 2:11; 1 John 3:1-3
- v8 — 1 Cor 6:9-10; Rev 2:11; Eph 5:5-6; Rev 22:15; Rev 20:14-15
- v23 — Isa 60:19-20; Rev 22:5; John 1:9; Rev 21:11; Isa 24:23
- v24 — Zech 8:22-23; Rev 22:2; Rev 21:26; Isa 66:18; Rom 15:10-12
- v25 — Isa 60:11; Zech 14:7; Rev 22:5; Isa 60:20; Rev 21:23
- v27 — Rev 22:14-15; Isa 52:1; Rev 20:15; Rev 3:5; Isa 35:8

Chapter 22

John sees the pure river of the water of life proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb, and the tree of life bearing twelve manner of fruits, whose leaves are for the healing of the nations. Christ declares, "I come quickly," and the Spirit and the bride say, "Come." A solemn warning is given: if any man adds to or takes away from the words of this prophecy, God shall add to him the plagues written in this book.

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| 1 | <i>And he shewed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb.</i> | He showed me a pure river of the water of life, clear as crystal, flowing from the throne of God and of the Lamb. |
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- 2 *In the midst of the street of it, and on either side of the river, was there the tree of life, which bare twelve manner of fruits, and yielded her fruit every month: and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations.* In the middle of the main street of the city, and on both sides of the river, stood the tree of life. It bears twelve kinds of fruit, yielding its fruit every month. The leaves of the tree are for the healing of the nations.
- 3 *And there shall be no more curse: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it; and his servants shall serve him:* There will be no more curse. The throne of God and of the Lamb will be in the city, and His servants will serve him.
- 4 *And they shall see his face; and his name shall be in their foreheads.* They will see His face, and His name will be on their foreheads.
- 5 *And there shall be no night there; and they need no candle, neither light of the sun; for the Lord God giveth them light: and they shall reign for ever and ever.* There will be no night there. They will need no lamp or sunlight, for the Lord God will give them light. They will reign forever and ever.
- 6 *And he said unto me, These sayings are faithful and true: and the Lord God of the holy prophets sent his angel to shew unto his servants the things which must shortly be done.* He said to me, "These words are faithful and true. The Lord God of the holy prophets sent His angel to show His servants the things that must soon take place."
- 7 *Behold, I come quickly: blessed is he that keepeth the sayings of the prophecy of this book.* "I am coming soon. Blessed is the one who keeps the words of the prophecy of this book."
- 8 *And I John saw these things, and heard them. And when I had heard and seen, I fell down to worship before the feet of the angel which shewed me these things.* I, John, saw and heard these things. When I had heard and seen them, I fell down to worship at the feet of the angel who had shown them to me.
- 9 *Then saith he unto me, See thou do it not: for I am thy fellowservant, and of thy brethren the prophets, and of them which keep the sayings of this book: worship God.* He said to me, "Do not do that. I am a fellow servant with You and Your brothers the prophets, and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God."

- 10 *And he saith unto me, Seal not the sayings of the prophecy of this book: for the time is at hand.* He said to me, "Do not seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the time is near."
- 11 *He that is unjust, let him be unjust still: and he which is filthy, let him be filthy still: and he that is righteous, let him be righteous still: and he that is holy, let him be holy still.* Let the one who does wrong keep doing wrong. Let the one who is filthy stay filthy. Let the one who is righteous keep doing right. Let the one who is holy continue to be holy.
- 12 *And, behold, I come quickly; and my reward is with me, to give every man according as his work shall be.* "I am coming soon, and My reward is with Me. I will give to each person according to what they have done."
- 13 *I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last.* "I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last."
- 14 *Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life, and may enter in through the gates into the city.* Blessed are those who keep His commandments. They will have the right to the tree of life and may enter the city through the gates.
- 15 *For without are dogs, and sorcerers, and whoremongers, and murderers, and idolaters, and whosoever loveth and maketh a lie.* Outside are the dogs, sorcerers, the sexually immoral, murderers, idolaters, and everyone who loves and practices falsehood.
- 16 *I Jesus have sent mine angel to testify unto you these things in the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, and the bright and morning star.* "I, Jesus, have sent My angel to testify these things to You for the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David — the bright and morning star."
- 17 *And the Spirit and the bride say, Come. And let him that heareth say, Come. And let him that is athirst come. And whosoever will, let him take the water of life freely.* The Spirit and the bride say, "Come." Let the one who hears say, "Come." Let the one who is thirsty come. Let anyone who desires it take the water of life freely.

18	<i>For I testify unto every man that heareth the words of the prophecy of this book, If any man shall add unto these things, God shall add unto him the plagues that are written in this book:</i>	I warn everyone who hears the words of the prophecy of this book: if anyone adds to these things, God will add to Him the plagues that are written in this book.
19	<i>And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.</i>	If anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God will take away His part from the book of life, from the holy city, and from the things written in this book.
20	<i>He which testifieth these things saith, Surely I come quickly. Amen. Even so, come, Lord Jesus.</i>	He who testifies to these things says, "Surely I am coming soon." Amen. Come, Lord Jesus.
21	<i>The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.</i>	The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

Words in this chapter:

grace — God's unearned kindness — a gift we could never earn or deserve, freely given.

Cross-References:

- v1** — Rev 7:17; John 4:14; John 7:38-39; Ps 36:8-9; John 4:10-11
- v2** — Rev 22:1; 1 Pet 2:24; Rev 2:7; Ezek 47:8-12; Gen 2:9
- v3** — Matt 25:21; Rev 21:3-4; John 12:26; Rev 7:15-17; John 14:3
- v4** — Matt 5:8; Rev 14:1; Rev 3:12; 1 John 3:2-3; Job 33:26
- v7** — Rev 1:3; Rev 3:11; Rev 22:20; Rev 22:12; Rev 22:9-10
- v11** — Dan 12:10; Prov 4:18; Ezek 3:27; 2 Tim 3:13; Matt 15:14
- v12** — Matt 16:27; Isa 62:11; Isa 40:10; 1 Cor 3:14; Rev 22:7
- v13** — Rev 1:8; Rev 21:6; Isa 44:6; Isa 48:12; Rev 1:17
- v14** — Rev 21:27; 1 John 5:3; Rev 22:7; 1 John 3:23-24; 1 John 3:3
- v16** — Rev 5:5; 2 Pet 1:19; Isa 11:1; Rev 1:4; Rom 1:3-4
- v17** — John 4:14; Rev 21:6; Isa 55:1-3; John 7:37; Isa 12:3
- v18** — Deut 12:32; Deut 4:2; Prov 30:6; Rev 1:3; Matt 15:6-9

The Bible is one story. It begins with God making all things and ending the workweek by walking with man in a garden, and it ends with God making all things new and ending the long ages by dwelling with man in a city that is itself a garden. Everything between the bookends is the story of how He got us back.